

Tafsir Ibn Kathir

Abridged English Edition (Darussalam)

Faithful text extraction with PDF page citations

114 Surahs — 10 Volumes

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Surah 1: Al-Fatihah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 42–44]

The Meaning of Al- Fatihah and its« Various Names This Surah is called Al-Fatihah, that is, the Opener of the Book, the Surah with which prayers are begun. It is also called, Umm Al-Kitab (the Mother of the Book), according to the majority of the scholars. In an authentic Hadith recorded by At- Tirmidhi, who graded it Sa hih , Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, » , , f , pi iSj <U JLq^Jl@c'j jiidi uAl-Hamdu lilldhi Rabbil-'Alamin is the Mother of the Qur'an, the Mother of the Book, and the seven repeated Ai/at of the Glorious Qur'an .» It is also called Al-Hamd and As-Salah, because the Prophet said that his Lord said,

* <JJ 1 <J15 “The prayer (i.e Al-Fatihah) is divided into two halves between Me and My servants.' When the servant says, 'All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of existence,' Allah says, 'My servant has praised Me.'n Al-Fatihah was called the Salah, because reciting it is a condition for the correctness of Salah - the prayer. Al-Fatihah was also called Ash-Shifa' (the Cure). It is also called Ar-Ruqyah (remedy), since in the Sahih, there is the narration of Abu Said telling the the story of the Companion who used Al-Fatihah as a remedy for the tribal chief who was poisoned. Later, the Messenger of Allah jg said to a Companion, t , Lfjl SjjJj “How did you know that it is a Ruqyah?^2] Al-Fatihah was revealed in Makkah as Ibn ‘Abbas, Qatadah and Abu Al-‘Aliyah stated. Allah said, 4u£<5' oi C- 1 4And indeed, We have bestowed upon you the seven Mathanty (seven repeatedly recited verses), (i.e. Surat Al-Fatihah) (15:87).*3 ' Allah knows best. HowmanyAyatdoes Al-Fatihah contain? There is no disagreement over the view that Al-Fatihah contains seven Ayat. According to the majority of the reciters of Al-Kufah, a group of the Companions, the Tdbi'in, and a number of scholars from the successive generations, the BismiUah is a separate Ayah in its beginning. We will mention this subject again soon, if Allah wills, and in Him we trust. The Number ofWords and Letters in Al-Fatihah The scholars say that Al-Fatihah consists of twenty-five words, and that it contains one hundred and thirteen letters. ^ At-Tirmidhi, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :283 . 121 Fath Al-Bari4 :529 . [31 That is, because this Ayah, which refers to Al-Fatihah, was itself revealed in Makkah

43Surah 1 . Al-Fatihah (Part-1

The Reason it is called UmmAl-Kitab

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 44–57]

In the beginning of the Book of Tafsir, in his Sahth, Al- Bukhari said; “It is called Umm Al-Kitab, because the Qur’an starts with it and because the prayer is started by reciting it.”¹¹¹ It was also said

that it is called Umm Al-Kitab, because it contains the meanings of the entire Qur'an. Ibn Jarir said, "The Arabs call every comprehensive matter that contains several specific areas an Umm. For instance, they call the skin that surrounds the brain, Umm Ar-Ra's. They also call the flag that gathers the ranks of the army an Umm." He also said, "Makkah was called Umm Al-Qura, (the Mother of the Villages) because it is the grandest and the leader of all villages. It was also said that the earth was made starting from Makkah."121 Further, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah narrated about Umm Al-Qur'an that the Prophet jyg said, ^ ^3 olyll ft £*» «If is Umm Al-Qur'dn, the seven repeated (verses) and the Glorious Qur'an. Also, Abu JaTar, Muhammad bin Jarir At-Tabari recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that the Messenger of Allah said about Al-Fatihah, a/t is Umtn Al-Qur'dn, Al-Fatihah of the Book (the Opener of the Qur'an) and the seven repeated (verses).^ Virtues of Al-Fatihah Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded in the Musnad that Abu Said bin Al-Mu'alla said, "I was praying when the Prophet called me, so I did not answer him until I finished the prayer. I then went to him and he said, «What prevented you from coming?» I said, 'O Messenger of Allah ! I was praying.' He said, «Didn't Allah say», Path Al-Bari 8:6. 121 At-Tabari 1 :107. 131 Ahmad 2 :448 At-Tabari 1 :107.

4r^=v^- Q. 'H J£.% v^-Lli iy^C Sijt 40 you who believe! Answer Allah (by obeying Him) and (His) Messenger when he (jg) calls you to that which gives you life?} He \$yg then said, 1 I ji oT^sJl ^ dlloJLp'^H «/ toil/ teach you the greatest Surah in the Qur'an before you leave the Masjid » He held my hand and when he was about to leave the Masjid, I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! You said: I will teach you the greatest Surah in the Qur'an.' He said, «Yes . 4 ' <—>j ju^il} •Al-Hamdu lilldhi Rabbil-'Alamim" ^ jUi» «It is the seven repeated (verses) and the Glorious Qur'an that I was given .»"* 11 Al-Bukhari,[21 Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah131 also recorded this Hadlth. Also, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Messenger of Allah jgj went out while Ubayy bin Ka*b was praying and said, sO Ubayy!* Ubayy did not answer him. The Prophet js said, «0 Ubayy!* Ubayy prayed faster then went to the Messenger of Allah saying, 'Peace be unto you, O Messenger of Allah!' He said, «Peace be unto you. O Ubayy, what prevented you from answering me when I called you?* He said, 'O Messenger of Allah! I was praying. He said, «Did you not read among what Allah has sent down to me, 14 'i' 1 iAnswer Allah (tn/ obeying Him) and (His) Messenger when he (?M) calls you to that which gives you life?} He said, 'Yes, O Messenger of Allah! I will not do it again.' the Prophet said, 111 Ahmad 4:211. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:6, 271. Abu Dawud 2 :150, An-Nasal 2 :139, and Ibn Majah 2 :1244.

Vj ji Yj Jr^X 1 Xj SljjBl ^ X j>' p ejy- <. iidUf M tWould you like me to teach you a Surah the likes of which nothing has been revealed in the Tawrdh, the Injtl, the Zabur (Psalms) or the Furqdn (the Qur'an)?' He said, "Yes, O Messenger of Allah!" The Messenger of Allah jg said, «/ hope that I ivill not leave through this door until you have learned itJ He (Ka*b) said, The Messenger of Allah held my hand while speaking to me. Meanwhile 1 was slowing down fearing that he might reach the door before he finished his conversation. When we came close to the door, I said: O Messenger of Allah ! What is the Surah that you have promised to teach me?' He said, ^What do you read in the prayer.» Ubayy said, 'So 1 recited Umm Al-Qur'an to him.' He jg said, j. X) jy.y ^ Xj J-^X* X* j. *•' Xp' ^ «jdJl \£\ jl «By Him in Wlwe Hand is my soul! Allah has never revealed in the Tawrdh, the Injil, the Zabur or the Furqdn a Surah like it. It is the seven repeated verses that I was givenJ?" Also, At-Tirmidhi recorded this Hadlth and in his narration,

the Prophet ﷺ said, ﷺ is the seven repeated verses and the Glorious Qur'an that I was given. » At-Tirmidhi then commented that this Hadith is Hasan Sahih. There is a similar Hadith on this subject narrated from Anas bin Malik²¹ Further, 'Abdullah, the son of Imam Ahmad, recorded this Hadith from Abu Hurayrah from Ubayy bin Ka'b, and he mentioned a longer but similar wording for the above Hadith. * In addition, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasab recorded this Hadith from Abu Hurayrah from Ubayy bin Ka'b who said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said. * 1] Ahmad 2 :412 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :283 * Al-Hakim 1:560. Ahmad 2:357 and 5:114.

jiiJi jhi'i } \ jL j^ vj j ij s'J '"" o-^r 6- ilriJ <*j—i 'Alltfi has never revealed in the Taivrdh or the Injil anything similar to Umm Al-Qur'dn . It is the seven repeated verses and it is divided into two halves between Allah and His servant . This is the wording reported by An-Nasab. At-Tirmidhi said that this Hadith is Hasan Gharib." Also, Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Jabir said, "I went to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ , after he had poured water (for purification) and said, 'Peace be unto you, O Messenger of Allah!' He did not answer me. So I said again, 'Peace be unto you, O Messenger of Allah!' Again, he did not answer me, so I said again, 'Peace be unto you, O Messenger of Allah!' Still he did not answer me. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ went while I was following him, until he arrived at his residence. I went to the Masjid and sat there sad and depressed. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ came out after he performed his purification and said, •Peace and Allah's mercy be unto you, peace and Allah's mercy be unto you, peace and Allah's mercy be unto you .» He then said, «0 'Abdullah bin Jabir! Should I inform you of the best Surah in the Qur'an? * I said, Yes, O Messenger of Allah!' He said, *Read, 'All praise be to Allah, the Lord of the existence,' until you finish if.n""2 ' This Hadith has a good chain of narrators. Some scholars relied on this Hadith as evidence that some Ayat and Surahs have more virtues than others. Furthermore, in the chapter about the virtues of the Qur'an, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Saïd Al-Khudri said, "Once, we were on a journey when a female servant came and said, The leader of this area has been poisoned and our people are away. Is there a healer among you?' Then a man whose healing expertise did not interest us stood for her, he read a Ruqyah for him, and he was healed. The chief gave him thirty sheep as a gift and some milk. When he came back to us we said to him, You know of a (new) Ruqyah, or did you do this before?' He said, 'I only used Umm Al-Kitab as Ruqyah,' We Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi8 :553 and An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 1 :318. ,2) Ahmad 4 :177 and Al-Muwatta 1 : 84.

said, 'Do not do anything further until we ask the Messenger of Allah.' When we went back to Al-Madlnah we mentioned what had happened to the Prophet The Prophet ﷺ said, "r*~IJ ^y.^i i jti »p * + / , <Sj L\$ji AjjAj jlj> J & *Who told him that it is a Ruqyah? Divide (the sheep) and reserve a sharefor we.®" Also, Muslim recorded in his Sahih, and An-Nasab in his Sunan that Ibn 'Abbas said, "While Jibril (Gabriel) was with the Messenger of Allah he heard a noise from above. Jibril lifted his sight to the sky and said, This is a door in heaven being open, and it has never been opened before now.' An angel descended from that door and came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, Receive the glad tidings of two lights that you have been given, which no other Prophet before you was given: the Opening of the Book and the last (three) Ayat of Surat Al-Baqarah. You will not read a letter of them, but will gain its benefit.' " This is the wording collected by An-Nasab (Al-Kubra 5:12) and Muslim recorded similar wording (1:554). Al-Fatihah and the Prayer Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet ﷺ said, «Whoever performs any prayer in which he did not read Umm Al-Qur'dti, then his prayer is

incomplete .” He said it thrice. Abu Hurayrah was asked, “(When) we stand behind the Imam?” He said, “Read it to yourself, for I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, *liU JL U jf JJI JU D :JLS lijj t£4A JLS 4. j 4js :Jlj :i)l JU :JU lj)i i : 111 JU i jl_ i Jlj) : Jli lj(i isff : i'f Jli) tsff bjbl : Jli lili 4 jLl. U ^JuaJj IJl& : Jli 1 csi -s Fath Al-Bari 8 :671*

he asked for.” Explaining this Hadith The last Hadith used the word Salah] ‘prayer’ in reference to reciting the Qur’an, (Al-Fatihah in this case) just as Allah said in another Ayah, *iAnd offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud nor in a low voice, but jbloiv a way betioeen.*} meaning, with your recitation of the Qur’an, as the Sahih. related from Ibn ‘Abbas. 121 Also, in the last Hadith, Allah said, “I have divided the prayer between Myself and My servant into two halves, a half for Me and a half for My servant. My servant shall have what he asked for.” Allah next explained the division that involves reciting Al-Fatihah, demonstrating the importance of reciting the Qur’an during the prayer, which is one of the prayer’s greatest pillars. Hence, the word ‘prayer’ was used here although only a part of it was actually being referred to, that is, reciting the Qur’an. Similarly, the word ‘recite’ was used where prayer is meant, as demonstrated by Allah’s statement, *iAnd recite the Qur'an in the early dawn . Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed. in reference to the Fajr prayer. The Two Sahlhs recorded that the angels of the night and the day attend this prayer.*¹³ Reciting Al-Fatihah is required in Every Rak‘ah of the Prayer All of these facts testify to the requirement that reciting the Qur’an (Al-Fatihah) in the prayer is required, and there is a consensus between the scholars on this ruling. The Hadith that we mentioned also testifies to this fact, for the Prophet said, Muslim 1 :296 , and An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubra 5:11,12. Fath Al-Bari 8 :257 ,3' Fath Al-Bari 8:251 and Muslim 1 :439.

1+-9 y' «W/ioraer performs any prayer in which he did not recite Umm Al-Qur'dn, his prayer is incomplete .»[1 Also, the Two Sahths recorded that ‘Ubadah bin As-Samit said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «There is no prayer for ivhoeever does not recite the Opening of the Book.nW Also, the Sahih of Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Hibban recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *ojTjiil Lfj \% 'j 5^Li> i V 6* “The prayer during which Umm Al-Qur'dn is not recited is invalid.#• There are many other Hadiths on this subject. Therefore, reciting the Opening of the Book, during the prayer by the Imam and those praying behind him, is required in every prayer, and in every Rak'ah. The TafsirofIstVadhah (seeking Refuge) Allah said, *f t _ r - .ff * Jrj— >> } >; • . - "U iShow forgiveness, enjoin what is good, and stay away from the foolish (i.e. don't putush them). And if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaytdn (Satan), then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is Hearing, Knowing> (7:199-200), iRepel evil with that which is better. We are Best-Acquainted 111 Ahmad 2:250. ^ Fath Al-Bari 2 :276 and Muslim 1 :295 I3 * Ibn Khuzaymah 1 :248, and Ibn Hibban 3 :139*

51Surah 1. Al-Fdtihah (Part-1) zvith things they utter. And say: "My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the whisperings (suggestions) of the Shaydtin (devils) And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they shoidd come near me."} (23:96-98) and, *!* >—*»• ci) ij'Jc. /CAij 4Li> tsff IjU (S? jf^ at ^Cc-k. ri y^bc. ji "\$i l^«lj Ly iiJLa 'jl 4 k jLiili LJL\ '1 & ~Zk LcJi iRepel (an evil) zvith one zohiclt is better, then verily he zvith zvhom there zvas enmity betzueen you, (zvill become) as though he zvas a close friend. But none is granted it except those zvho are patient — and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion (ofhappiness in the Hereafter, i.e. Paradise and of a high moral character) in this zworld. And if an evil zwhisper from Shaytdn tries to turn you axvay (O Muhammad sg) (from doing good),*

then seek refuge in Allah. Verily, He is the Hearing, the Knower.} (41:34-36) These are the only three Ayat that carry this meaning. Allah commanded that we be lenient human enemy, so that his soft nature might make him an ally and a supporter. He also commanded that we seek refuge from the Satanic enemy, because the devil does not relent in his enmity if we treat him with kindness and leniency. The devil only seeks the destruction of the Son of Adam due to the vicious enmity and hatred he has always had towards man's father, Adam. Allah said, *And We said to the Children of Adam! Let not Shaytan deceive you, as he got your parents [Adam and Hawwa' (Eve)] out of Paradise} (7:27), iSurely, Shaytan is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. He only invites his Hizb (followers) that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire (35:6) and, JXj jji djJ at "YCyf ilojj*

iWill you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the Zalimun (polytheists, and wrongdoers, etc)} (18:50). The devil assured Adam that he wanted to advise him, but he was lying. Hence, how would he treat us after he had vowed, i"By Your might, then I will surely, mislead them all. Except Your chosen servants among them (i.e. faithful, obedient, true believers of Islamic Monotheism)."} (38:82-83) Also, Allah said, -ft ^ iSo when you [want to] recite the Qur'an, seek refuge with Allah from Shaytan, the outcast (the cursed one). Verily, he has no power over those who believe and put their trust only in their Lord (Allah) . His power is only over those who obey and follow him (Satan), and those who join partners with Him.} (16:98-100). Seeking Refuge before reciting the Qur'an Allah said, ^ y'- -liU —to d'J> tito^ 4So when you [want to] recite the Qur'an, seek refuge with Allah from Shaytan, the outcast (the cursed one).} meaning, before you recite the Qur'an. Similarly, Allah said, }When you intend to offer As-Salah (the prayer), wash your faces and your hands (forearms)} (5:6) meaning, before you stand in prayer, as evident by the Hadiths that we mentioned. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said, "When the Messenger of Allah would*

*stand up in prayer at night, he would start his prayer with the Takbir (saying "Allahu Akbar Allah is Greater) and would then supplicate, y'l ij ,hJr JUu 3 bjtij J^Sji "All praise is due to You, O Allah, and also the thanks. Blessed be Your Name, Exalted be Your sovereignty, and there is no deity worthy of worship except You .» He would then say thrice, "iil VI V» »There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah, He would then say, jv^Jl Cri <1>L 3j£-t *1 seek refuge with Allah, the Hearing, the Knowing, from the cursed Satan, from his coercion, lures to arrogance and poems J." The four collectors of the Sunan recorded this Hadith, which At-Tirmidhi considered the most famous Hadith on this subject. Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded that Jubayr bin Mut'im said that his father said, "When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ started the prayer, he said, ii\ ouii - - \'jg ji iuil - - ^ 'fs\ iliu 4>£j ^-ji jiklji ly. it, ij-l Ji - iSc ''Allah is the Greater, truly the Greatest (thrice); all praise is due to Allah always (thrice); and all praise is due to Allah day and night (thrice). O Allah! I seek refuge with You from the cursed Satan, from his Hamz, Nafkh and NafthA" 'Amr said, "The Hamz means asphyxiation, the Nafkh means arrogance, and the Nafth means poetry. ""2) Also, Ibn Majah recorded that 'Ali bin Al-Mundhir said that Ibn Fudayl narrated that 'Ata' bin As-Sa'ib said that Abu 'Abdur-Rahman Ahmad 3:69, Abu Dawud 1:490, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 2:47, An- Nasal 2 :132 , and Ibn Majah Abu Dawud 1 :486 and Ibn Majah 1 :265.*

There are many other Hadiths about seeking refuge with Allah. One can find this subject in the books on supplication and the virtues of righteous, good deeds. Is the Isti'adhah (seeking Refuge) required? The majority of the scholars state that reciting the Isti'adhah (in the prayer and when reciting the Qur'an) is recommended and not required, and therefore, not reciting it does not constitute a sin. However, Ar-Razi recorded that 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah said that the Isti'adhah is required in the prayer and when one reads the Qur'an. In support of 'Ata's statement, Ar-Razi relied upon the apparent meaning of the Ayah, {Then seek refuge.} He said that the Ayah contains a command that requires implementation. Also, the Prophet (ﷺ) always said the Isti'adhah. In addition, the Isti'adhah wards off the evil of Satan, which is necessary, the rule is that the means needed to implement a requirement of the religion is itself also required. And when one says, "I seek refuge with Allah from the cursed devil." Then this will suffice. Virtues of the Isti'adhah The Isti'adhah cleanses the mouth from the foul speech that it has indulged in. It also purifies the mouth and prepares it to recite the speech of Allah. Further, the Isti'adhah entails seeking Allah's help and acknowledging His ability to do everything. The Isti'adhah also affirms the servant's meekness, weakness and inability to face the enemy of his inner evil, whom Allah alone. Who created this enemy, is able to repel and defeat. This enemy does not accept kindness, unlike the human enemy. There are three Ayat in the Qur'an that affirm this fact. Also, Allah said, {Verily, My servants (i.e. the true believers of Islamic Monotheism) — you have no authority over them. And sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian.} (17:65). We should state here that the believers, whom the human

enemies kill, become martyrs, while those who fall victim to the inner enemy - Satan - become bandits. Further, the believers who are defeated by the apparent enemy - disbelievers - gain a reward, while those defeated by the inner enemy earn a sin and become misguided. Since Satan sees man where man cannot see him, it is befitting that the believers seek refuge from Satan with Whom Satan cannot see. The Isti'adhah is a form of drawing closer to Allah and seeking refuge with Him from the evil of every evil creature.

What does Isti'adhah mean?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 57–58]

Isti'adhah means, "I seek refuge with Allah from the cursed Satan so that he is prevented from affecting my religious or worldly affairs, or hindering me from adhering to what I was commanded, or luring me into what I was prohibited from." Indeed, only Allah is able to prevent the evil of Satan from touching the son of Adam. This is why Allah allowed us to be lenient and kind with the human devil, so that his soft nature might cause him to refrain from the evil he is indulging in. However, Allah required us to seek refuge with Him from the evil of Satan, because he neither accepts bribes nor does kindness affect him, for he is pure evil. Thus, only He Who created Satan is able to stop his evil. This meaning is reiterated in only three Ayat in the Qur'an. Allah said in Surat Al-A'raf, {Shoio forgiveness, enjoin what is good, and turn away from the foolish (i.e. don't punish them).} (7:199) This is about dealing with human beings. He then said in the same Surah, {And if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan, then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is Hearing, Knowing (7: 200).} Allah also said in Surat Al-Mu'minun, {If - < > >• „ . . - > " ,/ / ^ >> •" t - " < ? - ;} .y I /if

Why the Devil is called Shaytan

And to guard against every rebellious devil. They cannot listen to the higher group (angels) for they are pelted from every side. Outcast, and theirs is a constant (or painful) torment. Except such as snatch away something by stealing, and they are pursued by a flaming fire of piercing brightness} (37:6-10). Further, Allah said. f in u i And indeed, We have put the big stars in the heaven and We beautified it for the beholders. And We have guarded it (near heaven) from every Shaytan Rajim (outcast Shaytdn). Except him (devil) wlv steals the hearing then he is pursued by a clear flaming fire>(15:16-18). There are several similar Ayat. It was also said that Rajim means, the person who throws or bombards things, because the devil throws doubts and evil thoughts in people's hearts. The first meaning is more popular and accurate. Bismillah is the First Ayah of Al-Fatihah The Companions started the Book of Allah with Bismillah: 4,1. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} The scholars also agree that Bismillah is a part of an Ayah

in Surat An-Naml {chapter 27). They disagree over whether it is a separate Ayah before every Surah, or if it is an Ayah, or a part of an Ayah, included in every Surah where the Bismillah appears in its beginning. Ad-Daraqutni also recorded a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah from the Prophet ﷺ that supports this Hadith by Ibn Khuzaymah. Also, similar statements were attributed to 'Ali, Ibn 'Abbas and others. The opinion that Bismillah is an Ayah of every Surah, except Al-Bara'ah (chapter 9), was attributed to (the Companions) Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn 'Umar, Ibn Az-Zubayr, Abu Hurayrah and 'Ali. This opinion was also attributed to the Tabi'in: 'Ata', Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, Makhul and Az-Zuhri. This is also the view of 'Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak, Ash-Shafil, Ahmad bin Hanbal, (in one report from him) Ishaq bin Rahwayh and Abu 'Ubayd Al-Qasim bin Salam. On the other hand, Malik, Abu Hanifah and their followers said that Bismillah is not an Ayah in Al-Fatihah or any other Surah. Dawud said that it is a separate Ayah in the beginning of every Surah, not part of the Surah itself, and this opinion was also attributed to Ahmad bin Hanbal. Basmalah aloud in the Prayer As for Basmalah aloud during the prayer, those who did not agree that it is a part of Al-Fatihah, state that the Basmalah should not be aloud. The scholars who stated that Bismillah is a part of every Surah (except chapter 9) had different opinions; some of them, such as Ash-Shafil, said that one should recite Bismillah with Al-Fatihah aloud. This is also the opinion of many among the Companions, the Tabi'in and the Imams of Muslims from the Salaf and the later generations. For instance, this is the opinion of Abu Hurayrah, Ibn 'Umar, Ibn 'Abbas, Mu'awiyah, *Umar and 'Ali - according to Ibn 'Abdul-Barr and Al-Bayhaqi. Also, the Four Khalifahs - as Al-Khatib reported - were said to have held this view although the report from them is contradicted. The Tabi'in scholars who gave this Tafsir include Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Abu Qilabah, Az-Zuhri, 'Ali bin Al-Hasan, his son Muhammad, Said bin Al-Musayyib, 'Ata', TawQs, Mujahid, Salim, Muhammad bin Kali ' Ad-Daraqutni 1 :303 and 306

Al-Qurazi, Abu Bakr bin Muhammad bin 'Amr bin Hazm, Abu Wa'il, Ibn Sirin, Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir, 'Ali bin 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, his son Muhammad, Nafi' the freed slave of Ibn 'Umar, Zayd bin Aslam, Umar bin 'Abdul-Aziz, Al-Azraq bin Qays, Habib bin Abi Thabit, Abu Ash-Sha'tha', Makhul and 'Abdullah bin Ma'qil bin Muqarrin. Also, Al-Bayhaqi added 'Abdullah bin Safwan, and Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah to this list. In addition, Ibn 'Abdul-Barr added 'Amr bin Dinar. The proof that these scholars relied on is that, since Bismillah is a part of Al-Fatihah, it should be recited aloud like the rest of Al-Fatihah. Also, An-Nasa'i recorded in his Sunan, Ibn Hibban and Ibn Khuzaymah in their Sahths and Al-Hakim in the Mustadrak, that Abu Hurayrah once performed the

prayer and recited Bismilldh aloud. After he finished the prayer, he said, “Among you, I perform the prayer that is the closest to the prayer of the Messenger of Allah sg.” Ad- Daraqutni, Al-Khatlb and Al-Bayhaqi graded this Hadith Sahiff 1] Furthermore, in Sahih. Al-Bukhari it is recorded that Anas bin Malik was asked about the recitation of the Prophet He said, “His recitation was unhurried.” He then demonstrated that and recited, while lengthening the recitation of Bismilldh Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim , ,2) Also, in the Musnad of Imam Ahmad, the Sunan of Abu Dawud, the Sahih of Ibn Hibban and the Mustadrak of Al-Hakim - it is recorded that Umm Salamah said, “The Messenger of Allah used to distinguish each Ayah during his recitation, iln the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. All praise and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. The Owner of the Day ofRecompense.y’ Ad-Daraqutni graded the chain of narration for this Hadith ^ An-Nasal 2:134, Ibn Khuzaymah 1:251, Ibn Hibban 3:143, Al- Hakim 1:232, Ad-Daraqutni 1:305, Al-Khatib and Al-Bayhaqi Fath Al-Bari 8 :709

Sahth^ Furthermore, Imam Abu ‘Abdullah Ash-Shafil and Al- Hakim in his Mustadrak, recorded that Mu'awiyah led the prayer in Al-Madinah and did not recite the Bismillah. The Muhajirin who were present at that prayer criticized that. When Mu'awiyah led the following prayer, he recited the Bismillah aloud. The Hadiths mentioned above provide sufficient proof for the opinion that the Bismillah is recited aloud. As for the opposing evidences and the scientific analysis of the narrations mentioned their weaknesses or otherwise it is not our desire to discuss this subject at this time. Other scholars stated that the Bismillah should not be recited aloud in the prayer, and this is the established practice of the Four Khalifahs, as well as ‘Abdullah bin Mughaffal and several scholars among the Tdbi'in and later generations. It is also the Madhhab (view) of Abu Hanifah, Ath-Thawri and Ahmad bin Hanbal. Imam Malik stated that the BismiUdh is not recited aloud or silently. This group based their view upon what Imam Muslim recorded that ‘A'ishah said that the Messenger of Allah jg used to start the prayer by reciting the Takbir (AUdhu Akbar; Allah is Greater) and then recite, »_>> A& iAU praise and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.} (Ibn Abi Hatim 1:12). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “I prayed behind the Prophet Abu Bakr, Umar and Uthman and they used to start their prayer with, iAU praise and thanks be to Allah, the Lord ofall that exists.} Muslim added, “And they did not mention, i® P iln the Name ofAlldh, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful} l 1 ! Ahmad 6:302, Abu Dawud 4:294, Ibn Khuzaymah 1:248, Al- Hakim 2 :231 , Ad-Daraqutni 1 :307 Musnad Al-Imam Ash-Shdfi‘i 1 :80 , Al-Hakim 1 :233

63Surah 1 , Al-Fatihah (Part-1) whether in the beginning or the end of the recitation.” Similar is recorded in the Sunan books from ‘Abdullah bin Mughaffal, may Allah be pleased with him.¹² These are the opinions held by the respected Imams, and their statements are similar in that they agree that the prayer of those who recite Al-Fatihah aloud or in secret is correct. All the favor is from Allah. The Virtue ofAl-Fatihah Imam Ahmad recorded in his Musnad, that a person who was riding behind the Prophet sfe said, “The Prophet’s animal tripped, so I said, ‘Cursed Shaytan.’ The Prophet sg said, JtFi ji-tU: ijUallji lil Jj;u 4jUalljl •t-jlllll jL 'j.Li; 4)i Iijj «Do not say, 'Cursed Shaytdtt/ for if you say these words, Satan becomes arrogant and says, With my strength I made him fall. When you say, 'Bismilldh,' Satan will become as small as a/ZyV31 Further, An-Nasa'i recorded in his book Al-Yawm wal-Laylah, and also Ibn Marduwyah in his Tafsir that Usamah bin ‘Umayr said, “I was riding behind the Prophet...” and he mentioned the rest of the above Hadith. The Prophet said in this narration, j*—; • J*

Vi . @ijCJL) IS" jj£j «Do not say these words, because then Satan becomes larger; as Fath Al-Bdri 2:265, and Muslim 1:299. We should state that Al- Hafiz Ibn Hajar Al-Asqalani said in his book Butugh Al-Maram, ‘Ahmad, An-Nasal and Ibn Khuzaymah recorded this wording (for the Hadith above) : They did not recite ^ I ^ iln the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful aloud.’ In another narration by Ibn Khuzaymah, They used to recite it sUently.’ This is the meaning intended (by the Hadith recorded by Muslim) .” ’ At-Tirmidhi no . 244 Ahmad 5 :59.

large as a house. Rather, say, 'Bismillah/ because Satan then becomes as small as a fly. u 1 ' 1 This is the blessing of reciting Bismillah. Basmalah is recommended before performing any Deed Basmalah (reciting Bismillah is recommended before starting any action or deed. For instance, Basmalah is recommended before starting a Khutbah (speech). The Basmalah is also recommended before one enters the place where he wants to relieve himself, there is a Hadith concerning this practice.' 2 ' Further, Basmalah is recommended at the beginning of ablution, for Imam Ahmad and the Sunan compilers recorded that Abu Hurayrah, Said bin Zayd and Abu Said narrated from the Prophet jg, JaIIP nil ^1 «There is no valid ablution for he who did not mention Allah's Name in This Hadith is Hasan (good). Also, the Basmalah is recommended before eating, for Muslim recorded in his Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Umar bin Abi Salamah while he was a child under his care, «Say Bismillah, eat with your right hand and eat from whatever is next to you Some of the scholars stated that Basmalah before eating is obligatory. Basmalah before having sexual intercourse is also recommended. The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. oik!51 £4- fr-i :Jvs iui 'J<i Si \i\ jliid Si M-ili ^ jJwj jl i\^jj L* (JUa-JLI I An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :142 'AwnAl-Ma'bud (the explanation of Sunan Abu Dawudj 1 :6 ' Ahmad 3:41, Abu Dawud 1:75, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:115, An- Nasal 1:61, and Ibn Majah 1 :140 (4) Muslim 3:1600.

“// anyone of you before having sexual relations with his wife says, 'In the Name of Allah. O Alldl! Protect us from Satan and also protect what you grant us (meaning the coming offspring) from Satan,' and if it is destined that they should have a child then, Satan zoill never be able to harm that child, it1 ' 1

The Meaning of “Allah” Allah is the Name of the Lord, the Exalted. It is said that Allah is the Greatest Name of Allah, because it is referred to when describing Allah by the various attributes. For instance, Allah said, & ft 'ft JfS\ jli y, V}, £l J. V & f>) & f'ffX fjxti wfS\ ft \ ill y \nVi 'jj Uj\$ o&R & f> iii Ai % jfti>J iHe is Allah, beside Whom Ld ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He) the Knmver of the unseen and the seen. He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. He is Allah, beside Whom Ld ilaha ilia Huwa, the King, the Holy, the One free from all defects, the Giver of security, the Watcher over His creatures, the Almighty, the Compeller, the Supreme. Glory be to Allah! (High is He) above all that they associate as partners with Him. He is Allah, the Creator, the Inventor of all things, the Bestmver of forms. To Him belong the Best Names. All that is in the heavens and the earth glorify Him. And He is the Almighty, the Wise) (59:22-24). Hence, Allah mentioned several of His Names as Attributes for His Name Allah. Similarly, Allah said, ZfX <£V1 kf) iAnd (all) the Most Beautiful Names belong to Allah, so call on Him by than) (7:180), and, *LL*y"l iji \fc-s, 6 d 11 \f.i\ jl iiiii [fj FathAl-Bari 9:136, Muslim 2:1058.

66 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir i.Say (O Muhammad sg :) "Invoke AUdh or invoke the Most Gracious (Aildh), by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names."} (17:110) Also, the Two Sahths recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, aAllah has ninety-nine Names, one hundred minus one, whoever counts (and preserves) than, will enter Paradise These Names were mentioned in a Hadith recorded by At- Tirmidhi*2 * and Ibn Majah, and there are several differences between these two narrations.

The Meaning of Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim - the Most

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 67–80]

Gracious, the Most Merciful Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim are two names derived from Ar- Rahmah (the mercy), but Rahman has more meanings that pertain to mercy than Ar-Rahim. There is a statement by Ibn Jarir that indicates that there is a consensus on this meaning. Further, Al-Qurtubi said, "The proof that these names are derived (from Ar-Rahmah), is what At-Tirmidhi recorded - and graded Sahlh from 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, O* t*"! J lii : (JUj ill JU» «Allah the Exalted said, 7 Am Ar-Rahmdn. I created the Raham (womb, i.e. family relations) and derived a name for it from My Name. Hence, ivhoeever keeps it, I will keep ties to him, and whoever severs it, I will sever ties with him He then said, "This is a text that indicates the derivation." He then said, "The Arabs denied the name Ar-Rahman, because of their ignorance about Allah and His attributes." Al-Qurtubi said, "It was said that both Ar-Rahman and Ar- Rahlm have the same meaning, such as the words Nadman 111 Fath Al-Bari 11:218, Muslim 4 :2062 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi9 :480 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1269 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :33

67Surah 1. Al-Fdtihah (Part-1) and Nadim, as Abu Ubayd has stated. Abu 'Ali Al-Farisi said, 'Ar-Rahman, which is exclusively for Allah, is a name that encompasses every type of mercy that Allah has. Ar-Rahlm is what effects the believers, for Allah said, 4And He is ever Rahim (merciful) to the believers.}' (33:43) Also, Ibn 'Abbas said - about Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahlm, They are two soft names, one of them is softer than the other (meaning it carries more implications of mercy).' Ibn Jarir said; As-Surri bin Yahya At-Tamimi narrated to me that 'Uthman bin Zufar related that Al-'Azrami said about Ar- Rahman and Ar-Rahlm, "He is Ar-Rahman with all creation and Ar-Rahfm with the believers."2 ' Hence. Allah's statements, 4Then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne (in a manner that suits His majesty), Ar-Rahman (25:59),^ and, 4Ar-Rahman (Allah) rose over (Istawa) the (Mighty) Throne (in a manner that suits His majesty).} (20:5) Allah thus mentioned the Istawa - rising over the Throne - along with His Name Ar-Rahman, to indicate that His mercy encompasses all of His creation. Allah also said, J^=fj} 4And He is ever Rahim (merciful) to the believers}, thus encompassing the believers with His Name Ar-Rahlm. They said, "This testifies to the fact that Ar-Rahman carries a broader scope ofmeanings pertaining to the mercy of Allah with His creation in both lives. Meanwhile, Ar-Rahlm is exclusively for the believers." Yet, we should mention that there is a supplication that reads, «The Rahman and the Rahim of this life and the Hereafter» 111 TafsirAl-Qurtubi 1:105. [2] At-Tabari 1 :127.

69Surah 1. Al-Fatihalt (Part-1) (merciful)} (9:128). Allah has also described some of His creation using some of His other Names. For instance, Allah said, iVerily, We have created man from Nutfah (drops) of mixed semen (sexual discharge of man and woman), in order to try him, so We made him hearer

(Sami') and seer (Basir) (76:2). In conclusion, there are several of Allah's Names that are used as names for others besides Allah. Further, some of Allah's Names are exclusive for Allah alone, such as Allah, Ar-Rahman, Al-Khaliq (the Creator), Ar-Raziq (the Sustainer), and so forth. Hence, Allah started the Tasmiyah (meaning, In the Name of Allah, Most Gracious Most Merciful') with His Name, Allah, and described Himself as Ar-Rahman, (Most Gracious) which is softer and more general than Ar-Rahm. The most honorable Names are mentioned first, just as Allah did here. A Hadith narrated by Umm Salamah stated that the recitation of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was slow and clear, letter by letter, yajji —sgfi . p *—~^}} i . . /u iln the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists. The Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. The Owner of the Day of Recompense} (1:1-4). And this is how a group of scholars recite it. Others connected the recitation of the Tasmiyah to Al-Hamd. 4l0laJhiji <_>j fu j1^S\} 42. Al-Hamd be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.} The Meaning of Al-Hamd Abu Jafar bin Jarir said, "The meaning of 4fa 1^{\}

iAl-Hamdu Lilldh (all praise and thanks be to Allah) is: all thanks are due purely to Allah, alone, not any of the objects that are being worshipped instead of Him, nor any of His creation. These thanks are due to Allah's innumerable favors and bounties, that only He knows the amount of. Allah's bounties include creating the tools that help the creation worship Him, the physical bodies with which they are able to implement His commands, the sustenance that He provides them in this life, and the comfortable life He has granted them, without anything or anyone compelling Him to do so. Allah also warned His creation and alerted them about the means and methods with which they can earn eternal dwelling in the residence of everlasting happiness. All thanks and praise are due to Allah for these favors from beginning to end." Further, Ibn Jarir commented on the Ayah, iAl-Hamdu Lilldh}, that it means, "A praise that Allah praised Himself with, indicating to His servants that they too should praise Him, as if Allah had said, 'Say: All thanks and praise is due to Allah.' It was said that the statement, 4A11 praise and thanks be to Allah}, entails praising Allah by mentioning His most beautiful Names and most honorable Attributes. When one proclaims, 'All thanks are due to Allah,' he will be thanking Him for His favors and bounties." 12 The Difference between Praise and Thanks Hamd is more general, in that it is a statement of praise for one's characteristics, or for what he has done. Thanks are given for what was done, not merely for characteristics. The Statements of the Salaf about Al-Hamd Hafis mentioned that 'Umar said to 'Ali, "We know La ilaha illallah, Subhan Allah and Allahu Akbar. What about Al-Hamdu Lilldh?" 'Ali said, "A statement that Allah liked for At-Tabari 1:135. At-Tabari 1 :137.

Himself, was pleased with for Himself and He likes that it be repeated."111 Also, Ibn 'Abbas said, "Al-Hamdu Lillah is the statement of appreciation. When the servant says Al-Hamdu Lillah, Allah says, 'My servant has praised Me.'" Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this HadithP The Virtues of Al-Hamd Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Al-Aswad bin Sari' said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Should I recite to you words of praise for My Lord, the Exalted, that I have collected?' He said, dLj jl LU ^Verily, your Lord likes Al-Hamd . An-Nasab also recorded this HadithP^ Furthermore, Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah recorded that Musa bin Ibrahim bin Kathir related that Talhah bin Khirash said that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, jLuJi i Jiii ijj V Jjiu «77ie best Dhikr (remembering Allah) is Ld ilaha illallah and the best supplication is Al-Hamdu Lillah . At-Tirmidhi said that this Hadlth is Hasan Gharib. 141 Also, Ibn Majah recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, iL; J~isi j(5 Ml .uAJl : Jlii iLL jIp <5>l jLwl «No servant is

blessed by Allah and says/Al-Hamdu Lillah', except that what he was given is better than that which he has himself acquired. »[s] Further, in his Sunan, Ibn Majah recorded that Ibn Tjmar 111 At-Tabari. 1 : 15. 121 Ibid. 1 :13. 131 Ahmad 3 :435 , and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 4:416. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :324, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :208, Ibn Majah [5] Ibn Majah 2:1250

72 * Tafsir Ibn Kathir said that the Messenger of Allah j|| said, (J <J^»J -uAll tLD i—>j IS : Jj <Ssl jlle Ijl* j|i> l3j 'J 'JUi ail Jj lu« IfjL^xj <liS IjjJj j*Ii jjlsijL oJLajo . . 'M1UI : oXp JU LL 1 4)1 JU i vials' V JJlzS Jli A* Ijlp o^ ^j ^ -U^Jl jjj ! Jli ajI iljj U !^IS !Sl Jiil: Jj- ,£X* Jli as Uds-I :L\$ Jii jiii .dujLL ijI^J 8 . If> “A servant of Allah once said, 'O Allah! Yours is the Hamd that is suitable for the grace of Your Face and the greatness of Your Supreme Authority.' The two angels were confused as to how to write these words. They ascended to Allah and said, 'O our Lord! A servant has just uttered a statement and we are unsure how to record it for him.' Allah said while having more knowledge in what His servant has said, 'What did My servant say?' They said, 'He said, 'O Allah! Yours is the Hamd that is suitable for the grace of Your Face and the greatness of Your Supreme Authority.' Allah said to them, 'Write it as My servant has said it, until he meets Me and then I shall reward him for it.' i) Al before Hamd encompasses all Types of Thanks and Appreciation for Allah The letters Alif and Lam before the word Hamd serve to encompass all types of thanks and appreciation for Allah, the Exalted. A Hadith stated. idp £jl hsLf iiiiS ilUjl dij ,'^s juJl ill ^liis oils' «0 Allah! All of Al-Hamd is due to You, You own all the ownership, all types of good are in Your Hand and all affairs belong to YouM2 111 Ibn Majah 2:1249. 121 At-TarghJb wat-Tarhib 2 :253

73 Surah 1. Al-Fatihah (Part-1) The Meaning of Ar-Rabb, the Lord Ar-Rabb is the owner who has full authority over his property. Ar-Rabb, linguistically means, the master or the one who has the authority to lead. All of these meanings are correct for Allah. When it is alone, the word Rabb is used only for Allah. As for other than Allah, it can be used to say Rabb Ad-Dar, the master of such and such object. Further, it was reported that Ar-Rabb is Allah's Greatest Name. The Meaning of Al-'Alamin Al-'Alamin is plural for 'Alam, which encompasses everything in existence except Allah. The word Alam is itself a plural word, having no singular form. The Alamin are different creations that exist in the heavens and the earth, on land and at sea. Every generation of creation is called an Alam. Al- Farra' and Abu Tjbayd said, “Alam includes all that has a mind, the Jinns, mankind, the angels and the devils, but not the animals.” Also, Zayd bin Aslam and Abu Muhaysin said, Alam includes all that Allah has created with a soul.” Further, Qatadah said about, iThe Lord of the 'Alamin}, “Every type of creation is an Alam.” Az-Zajjaj also said, “ Alam encompasses everything that Allah created, in this life and in the Hereafter.” Al-Qurtubi commented, “This is the correct meaning, that the Alam encompasses everything that Allah created in both worlds. Similarly, Allah said, o' iFir'awn (Pharaoh) said: "And what is the Lord of the 'Alamin?" Musa (Moses) said: "The Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, if you seek to be convinced with certainty" (26 :23-24). Why is the Creation called 'Alam? Alam is derived from Alamah, that is because it is a sign testifying to the existence of its Creator and to His Oneness.” m Al-Qurtubi 1 :139

-4 >' 43. Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), Ar-Rahim (the Most Merciful)}. Allah said next, 4Ar-Rahmdn (the Most Gracious), Ar-Raliim (the Most Merciful)} We explained these Names in the Basmalah. Al-Qurtubi said, “Allah has described Himself by 'Ar-Rahman, Ar-Rahim' after saying 'the

Lord of the Alamin', so His statement here includes a warning, and then an encouragement. Similarly, Allah said, jVj ,if.l Gi tji li^} iDeclare (O Muhammad unto My servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.) (15:49-50)* ” Allah said, iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} (6:165) Hence, Rabb contains a warning while Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim encourages. Further, Muslim recorded in his Sahih. that the Messenger of Allah jg said, U J*I5sj I fj i. Jjy-'l L 4)1 JCj~ li jJluj U» la.< U ^31 -dll Jup *If the believer knew what punishment Allah has, none would have hope in acquiring His Paradise, and if the disbeliever knew what mercy Allah has, none will lose hope of earning His reward.*12' s'j. 44. The Owner of the Day ofRecompense.} Indicating Sovereignty on the Day ofJudgment Allah mentioned His sovereignty of the Day of Resurrection, 111 Ibid. 121 Muslim 4:2109.

75Surah 1. Al-Fatihah (Part-1 but this does not negate His sovereignty over all other things. For Allah mentioned that He is the Lord of existence, including this earthly life and the Hereafter. Allah only mentioned the Day of Recompense here because on that Day, no one except Him will be able to claim ownership of anything whatsoever. On that Day, no one will be allowed to speak without His permission. Similarly, Allah said, rA . J'b j 4 U~» iSoiU'j [ji: fj.} iThe Day that Ar-Ruh (Jibril (Gabriel) or another angel) and the angels will stand forth in rows, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (Allah) allows, and he will speak what is right.} (78:38), 4) ^} iAnd all voices will be humbled for the Most Gracious (Allah), and nothing shall you hear but the voice of their footsteps.}(20:108), and, - x> s' ».' •> • ' •>iik J-* 4 ot £} iOti the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah's) leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed} (11:105). Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, “Allah says, ‘On that Day, no one owns anything that they used to own in the world.’” The Meaning ofYawmAd-Din Ibn 'Abbas said, “Yawm Ad-Din is the Day of Recompense for the creatures, meaning the Day ofJudgment. On that Day, Allah will reckon the creation for their deeds, evil for evil, good for good, except for thosewhom He pardons. In addition, several other Companions, Tabi'in and scholars of the Salaf, said similarly, for this meaning is apparent and clear from the Ayah. Allah is Al-Malik (King or Owner) Allah is the True Owner (Malik) (of everything and everyone). Allah said, 111 IbnAbi Hfitim 1:19.

J./M QX>^% 4He is Allah, beside Whom Ld ildha ilia Huwa, the King, the Holy, the One freefrom all defects> (59:23). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that

the Prophet jg said, «4l V) ilJU l 4IIL JLz Jf-j <Ll r- '’The most despicable name to Allah is a person who calls himself the king of kings, while there are no owners except Am. Also the Two Sahihs recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^jt' itllLeJl ui : JjZ Cm »LLUl f&jj ^0 I <2)1 S' ^ ^ “(On f/i<? Day ofJudgement) Allah will grasp the earth andfold up the heavens with His Right Hand and proclaim, TAm the King! Where are the kings of the earth? Where are the tyrants? Where are the arrogant?’^ Also, in the the Glorious Qur'an; 4j0\ iilif gfr iWhose is the kingdom this Day? Allah's, the One, the Irresistible .4(40 : 16) As for calling someone other than Allah a king in this life, then it is done as a figure of speech. For instance, Allah said, 4Indeed Allah appointed Tdlut (Saul) as a king over you)> (2:247), CiKjfr 4As there was a king behind them}(18:79), and, 4tPP^j J£- H ^ Path Al-Bari 1 : 604 and Muslim 3 :1688 Fath Al-Bari 13 :404 and Muslim 4 :2148

78 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir is described as Mu'abbadah, meaning, 'paved'. In religious terminology, 'Ibadah implies the utmost love, humility and fear. The Merit of stating the Object of the Action before the Doer of the Act, and the Merit of these Negations "You...", means, we worship You alone and none else, and rely on You alone and none else. This is the perfect form of obedience and the entire religion is implied by these two ideas. Some of the Salaf said, Al-Fatihah is the secret of the Qur'an, while these words are the secret of Al-Fatihah, JO 45. You we worship, and You we ask for help from.} The first part is a declaration of innocence from Shirk (polytheism), while the second negates having any power or strength, displaying the recognition that all affairs are controlled by Allah alone. This meaning is reiterated in various instances in the Qur'an. For instance, Allah said, / / C // y 4 So I worship Him (O Muhammad s) and put your trust in Him. And your Lord is not unaware of what you (people) do.} (11:123), i & f . i L'i : & J \$ j i > i Say: "He is the Most Gracious (Allah), in Him we believe, and in Him we put our trust."} (67:29), 4 (He alone is) the Lord of the east and the west; L d i l d h a i l i a H u w a (none has the right to be worshipped but He). So take Him alone as Wakil (Disposer of your affairs)}, (73:9), and. i j j u j j j L o 4 You we worship, and You we ask for help from.}. We should mention that in this Ayah, the type of speech here changes from the third person to direct speech by using the Kaf in the statement Iyyaka (You). This is because after the servant praised and thanked Allah, he stands before Him,

The beginning of Surat Al-Fatihah contains Allah's praise for

Himself by His most beautiful Attributes and indicates to His servants that, they too, should praise Him in the same manner. Hence, the prayer is not valid unless one recites Al-Fatihah, if he is able. The Two Sahihs recorded that Tjbadah bin As-Samit said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, <<_li£Jl iALL «Tliere is tw valid prayerfor whoever does not recite Al-Fatilah of the BooleV Also, it is recorded in Sahih Muslim that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, J if?j u-i xJxi : JU; li)i J^a;» :<iil Jli icjjJLJ' :juW Jli lil ijlj, li :Jli li^i :Jjil Jli ^>l>:Jli lip JtM*- jJblj x-*j JilJ : Jli lj|3 i^Jup :ii)l Jli _>j liUx tjiti.Jli lili tJLi U fjsSij ^jj IJL* : Jli . % ^k. 0 Cx/jj' Osffl\\ •Jli U Iju : Jli iAllah said, 7

divided the prayer into two halves between Myself and My servant, one half is for Me and one half for My servant. My servant shall have what he asks for.' When the servant says, 'All praise and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.', in Fath Al-Bari 2 :276 and Muslim 1 :295

80 Tafseer Ibn Kathir Allah says, 'My servant has praised Me.' When the servant says, 'The Most Gracious, the Most Merciful', Allah says, 'My servant has praised Me.' When the servant says, 'The Owner of the Day of Recompense', Allah says, 'My servant has glorified Me.' If the servant says, 'Iltijj JI-jo Jiljt^ iYoti we worship, and You we ask for help', Allah says, 'This is between Me and My servant, and My servant shall have what he asked.' If the servant says, 'Guide us to the straight path. The path of those on whom You have bestowed Your grace, not (that) of those who have earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray', Allah says, 'This is for My servant, and My servant shall have what he asked.' Tawhid Al-Uluhiyyah Ad-Dahhak narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, 'X~^ iYou we worship' means, 'It is You whom we single out, Whom we fear and Whom we hope in, You alone, our Lord, and none else. Tawhid Ar-Rububiyyah icss } And You we ask for help from', to obey you and in all of our affairs. '*21 Further, Qatadah said that the Ayah, 'M\} 111 Muslim 1 :297. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :19.

81 Surah 1. Al-Fatihah (Part-1) 'You we worship, and You we ask for help from' 'Contains Allah's command to us to perform sincere worship for Him and to seek His aid concerning all of our affairs.' ' Allah mentioned, 'Juju jIjJ4 'You we worship' before, '44?~ 4And You we ask for help from', because the objective here is the worship, while Allah's help is the tool to implement this objective. Certainly, one first takes care of the most important aspects and then what is less important, and Allah knows best. Allah called His Prophet^ an 'Abd Allah called His Messenger jg an 'Abd (servant) when He mentioned sending down His Book, the Prophet's involvement in inviting to Him, and when mentioning the Isra' (overnight journey from Makkah to Jerusalem and then to heaven), and these are the Prophet's most honorable missions. Allah said, '4^3' *£ '6- ' k 4AU praise and thanks be to Alldlt, Who has sent down to His servant (Muhammad the Book (the Qur'an)) (18:1), '4 <il JLt Cl 'f^i} 4And when the servant of Allah (Muhammad is) stood up invoking Him (his Lord - Allah in prayer)), (72:19) and, '4^J *:jJJu Isfj Cjft J*CL.} 4Glorified (and Exalted) be He (Allah) (above all that they associate with Him) Who took His servant (Muhammad %) for a journey by night (17:1). Encouraging the Performance of the Acts of Worship during Times of Distress Allah also recommended that His Prophet sg resort to acts of worship during times when he felt distressed because of the 111 Ibid. 1 :20

they associate with You)! Truly, / have been of the wrongdoers) (21:87). Further, one may praise Him without mentioning what he needs. The Meaning of Guidance mentioned in the Surah The guidance mentioned in the Surah implies being directed and guided to success. Allah said, '«)' iGuide us to the straight path) meaning guide, direct, lead and grant us the correct guidance. Also, ' 'ojwJi iAnd shown him the two ways (good and evil)? (90:10), means, 'We explained to him the paths of good and evil.' Also, Allah said, '4He (Allah) chose him (as an intimate friend) and guided him to a straight path) (16:121), and, 'iAnd lead them on to the zuay offlaming Fire (Hell)) (37:23). Similarly, Allah said, 'iAnd verily, you (O Muhammad sg) are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight path) (42:52), and, '4u4l <s\$ *^ jSQ) iAll praise and thanks be to Allah, Who has guided us to this) (7:43), meaning, guided us and directed us and qualified us for this end - Paradise.

The Meaning of As-Sirat Al-Mustaqim, the Straight

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 84–94]

Path. As for the meaning of As-Sirat Al-Mustaqim, Imam Abu Ja'far

At-Tabari said, "The Ummah agreed that Sirdt Al-Mustaqim, is the clear path without branches, according to the language of the Arabs. For instance, Jarir bin 'Atiyah Al-Khatafi said in a poem, The Leader of the faithful is on a path that will remain straight even though the other paths are crooked." At-Tabari also stated that, "There are many evidences to this fact." At-Tabari then proceeded, "The Arabs use the term, Siraf in reference to every deed and statement whether righteous or wicked. Hence the Arabs would describe the honest person as being straight and the wicked person as being crooked. The straight path mentioned in the Qur'an refers to Islam. Imam Ahmad recorded in his Musnad that An-Nawwas bin Sam'an said that the Prophet jg said, [j*111 If* I 11 •Jy& frlS ia\j^ai\ toli-'j* jfo* >— _ * ' jljf Ijli y-Sj ^yry jj *>cja V JI* *dJ*i iy 1~^ J •ilijj 41 «— 4i • ui' .u\ti ^ 41 i»ij J.1^11 *41 4^ *i;i» > ^ijJi "Allah has set an example: a Sirdt (straight path) that is surrounded by two walls on both sides, with several open doors within the walls covered with curtains. There is a caller on the gate of the Sirat who heralds, 'O people! Stay on the path and do not deviate from it.' Meanwhile, a caller from above the path is also warning any person who wants to open any of these doors, Woe unto you! Do not open it, for if you open it you will pass through.' The straight path is Islam, the two walls are Allah's set limits, while the doors resemble what Allah has prohibited. The caller on the gate of the Sirdt is the Book of Allah, while the caller above the Sirat is Allah's admonishment in the heart of every Muslim At-Jabari 1:170. [2] Ahmad 4: 182.

85 Surah 1. Al-Fatihah (Part-1) The Faithful ask for and abide by Guidance If someone asks, "Why does the believer ask Allah for guidance during every prayer and at other times, while he is already properly guided? Has he not already acquired guidance?" The answer to these questions is that if it were not a fact that the believer needs to keep asking for guidance day and night, Allah would not have directed him to invoke Him to acquire the guidance. The servant needs Allah the Exalted every hour of his life to help him remain firm on the path of guidance and to make him even more firm and persistent on it. The servant does not have the power to benefit or harm himself, except by Allah's permission. Therefore, Allah directed the servant to invoke Him constantly, so that He provides him with His aid and with firmness and success. Indeed, the happy person is he whom Allah guides to ask of Him. This is especially the case if a person urgently needs Allah's help day or night. Allah said, IS ^ jit (jLjli i gftjj I £{)£} 43? u;& 40 you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger (Muhammad %g), and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He sent down to those before (him)) (4:16). Therefore, in this Ayah Allah commanded the believers to believe, and this command is not redundant since what is sought here is firmness and continuity of performing the deeds that help one remain on the path of faith. Also, Allah commanded His believing servants to proclaim, 4;£4.£iiA he k'JM Q Aj h£ £* * <£} iOur Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower.} (3:8). Hence, iGuide us to the straight way} means, "Make us firm on the path of guidance and do not allow us to deviate from it."

V) p+sc j*. jv^Ac e-jit Cjl/jj''' 47. 77ie way 0/ those upon whom You have bestowed Your grace, not (that) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray}. We mentioned the Hadith in which the servant proclaims, iGuide us to the straight way and Allah says, "This is for My servant, and My servant shall acquire what he asks for." Allah's statement. iThe way of those upon whom You have bestowed Your grace defines the path. Those upon whom Allah has bestowed His grace' are those mentioned in Surat An-Nisa' (chapter 4), when Allah said, / .-'7 * /V * i iAnd whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger (Muhammad \$&), then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, the Prophets, the Siddiqin (the truly faithful), the martyrs, and the righteous. And how excellent these companions are! Such is the bountyfrom Allah, and Allah is sufficient to know (4:69-70). Allah's statement, jCc-} iNot (the way) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray } meaning guide us to the straight path, the path of those upon whom you have bestowed Your grace, that is, the people of guidance, sincerity and obedience to Allah and His Messengers. They are the people who adhere to Allah's commandments and refrain from committing what He has prohibited. But, help us to avoid the path of those whom Allah is angry with, whose intentions are corrupt, who know the truth, yet deviate from it. Also, help us avoid the path of those

87Surah 1. Al-Fdtihah (Part-1) who were led astray, who lost the true knowledge and, as a result, are wandering in misguidance, unable to find the correct path. Allah asserted that the two paths He described here are both misguided when He repeated the negation 'not'. These two paths are the paths of the Christians and Jews, a fact that the believer should beware of so that he avoids them. The path of the believers is knowledge of the truth and abiding by it. In comparison, the Jews abandoned practicing the religion, while the Christians lost the true knowledge. This is why 'anger' descended upon the Jews, while being described as "led astray" is more appropriate of the Christians. Those who know, but avoid implementing the truth, deserve the anger, unlike those who are ignorant. The Christians want to seek the true knowledge, but are unable to find it because they did not seek it from its proper resources. This is why they were led astray. We should also mention that both the Christians and the Jews have earned the anger and are led astray, but the anger is one of the attributes more particular of the Jews. Allah said about the Jews, ii' iii iThose (Jews) who incurred the curse ofAllah and His wrath (5:60). The attribute that the Christians deserve most is that of being led astray, just as Allah said about them, 4^J' £ j* <jcL=. tfeS; JJj iWho wait astray before and who misled many, and strayed (themselves)from the right path} (5:77). There are several Hadiths and reports from the Salaf on this subject. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Adi bin Hatim said, "The horsemen of the Messenger of Allah sg seized my paternal aunt and some other people. When they brought them to the Messenger of Allah they were made to stand in line before him. My aunt said, 'O Messenger of Allah! The supporter is far away, the offspring have stopped coming and I am an old woman, unable to serve. Grant me your favor, may Allah grant you His favor.' He said, "Who is your supporter?" She said, 'Adi bin Hatim.' He said, The one who ran away from Allah and His Messenger?" She said, 'So, the Prophet jg freed me.' When the

Prophet jg came back, there was a man next to him, I think that he was 'Ali, who said to her, 'Ask him for a means of transportation.' She asked the Prophet jg, and he ordered that she be given an animal." 'Adi then said, "Later on, she came to me and said, 'He (Muhammad jg) has done a favor that your father (who was a generous man) would never have done. So and-so person came to him and he granted him his favor, and so-and-so came to him and he granted him his favor.' So I went to the Prophet sg and

found that some women and children were gathering with him, so close that I knew that he was not a king like Kisra (King of Persia) or Caesar. He said, ‘O ‘Adi! What made you run away, so that La ilaha illalldh is not proclaimed? Is there a deity worthy of worship except Allah? What made you run away, so that AUa.hu Akbar (AllaH is the Greater) is not proclaimed? Is there anything Greater than Allah?’ I proclaimed my Islam and I saw his face radiate with pleasure and he said: J ^ .1 i 1 c. Ljj .1^W 1 “Those who have earned the anger are the Jeivs and those who are led astray are the Christians This HacLUh was also collected by At-Tirmidhi who said that it is Hasan Gharib . (1 Also, when Zayd bin ‘Amr bin Nufayl went with some of his friends - before Islam - to Ash-Sham seeking the true religion, the Jews said to him, “You will not become a Jew unless you carry a share of the anger of Allah that we have earned.” He said, “I am seeking to escape Allah’s anger.” Also, the Christians said to him, “If you become one of us you will carry a share in Allah’s discontent.” He said, “I cannot bear it.” So he remained in his pure nature and avoided worshipping the idols and the polytheistic practices. He became neither a Jew, nor Christian. As for his companions, they became Christians because they found it more pure than Judaism. Waraqah bin Nawfal was among these people until Allah guided him by the hand of His Prophet §g, when he was sent as Prophet, and Waraqah believed in the revelation that was sent to the Prophet may Allah be pleased with him. *** Ahmad 4:378, and Tuhfat At-Ahwadhi 8:289.

The Summary of Al-Fatihah The honorable Surah Al-Fatihah contains seven Ayat including the praise and thanks of Allah, glorifying Him and praising Him by mentioning His most Beautiful Names and most high Attributes. It also mentions the Hereafter, which is

the Day of Resurrection, and directs Allah’s servants to ask of Him, invoking Him and declaring that all power and strength comes from Him. It also calls to the sincerity of the worship of Allah alone, singling Him out in His divinity, believing in His perfection, being free from the need o any partners, having no rivals nor equals. Al-Fatihah directs the believers to invoke Allah to guide them to the straight path, which is the true religion, and to help them remain on that path in this life, and to pass over the actual Sirat (bridge over hell that everyone must pass over) on the Day of Judgment. On that Day, the believers will be directed to the gardens of comfort in the company of the Prophets, the truthful ones, the martyrs and the righteous. Al-Fatihah also encourages performing good deeds, so that the believers will be in the company of the good-doers on the Day of Resurrection. The Surah also warns against following the paths of misguidance, so that one does not end up being gathered with those who indulge in sin, on

the Day of Resurrection, including those who have earned the anger and those who were led astray. The Bounties are because of Allah, not the Deviations Allah said, iThe way of those upon whom you have bestowed Your grace>, when He mentioned His favor. On mentioning anger, Allah said, Jl iNot (that) of those who earned Your anger without mentioning the subject, although it is He Who has sent down the anger on them, just as Allah stated in another Ayah, 'if 9% Jl j \$¥ 4Have you (O Muhammad jg) not seen those (hypocrites) who take as friends a people upon whom is the wrath of Allah (i.e.

90 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr Jews)?} (58:14). Also, Allah relates the misguidance of those who indulged in it, although they were justly misguided according to Allah’s appointed destiny. For instance, Allah said, tb (*J J-4 -Sj T&f-J' J+* -i-t. 4He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided ; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Waif (guiding friend) to lead him (to the right path)) (18:17) and,

^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him ; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgression} (7:186). These and several other Ayat testify to the fact that Allah alone is the One Who guides and misguides, contrary to the belief of the Qadariyyah sect, who claimed that the servants choose and create their own destiny. They rely on some unclear Ayat avoiding what is clear and contradicts their desires. Theirs, is the method of the people who follow their lust, desire and wickedness. An authentic Hadith narrated, <1>1 (jo-i jjJI au aJLIj U JI pjlj lil® zWhcn you see those who follow what is not so clear in it (the Qur'an), then they are those whom Allah has mentioned (refer to 3:7). Hence, avoid them.d 11 The Prophet jg was referring to Allah's statement, /to Z, •*> *** + • v '^ "' & » *.£•*' .?? V iUwlj *UC»l Al4 A££ U £>3 4 Uliy 4S0 as for those in whose hearts there is a deviation (from the truth) they follow that which is not entirely clear thereof, seeking Al-Fitnah (polytheism and trials), and seeking for its hidden meanings}(3:7). Verily, no innovator in the religion could ever rely on any authentic evidence in the Qur'an that testifies to his innovation. The Qur'an came to distinguish between truth and falsehood, and guidance and misguidance. The Qur'an does 111 FathAl-Bdri8:57.

91Surah 1. Al-Fatihah (Part-1) not contain any discrepancies or contradictions, because it is a revelation from the Most Wise, Worthy of all praise. SayingAmin It is recommended to say Amin after finishing the recitation of Al-Fatihah. Amin means, "O Allah! Accept our invocation." The evidence that saying Amin is recommended is contained in what Imams Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi recorded, that Wa'il bin Hujr said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg recite, 4Not (that) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray and he said 'Amin' extending it with his voice."111 Abu Dawud's narration added, "Raising his voice with it." At- Tirmidhi then commented that this Hadith is Hasan and was also narrated from 'Ali and Ibn Mas'ud121 . Also, Abu Hurayrah narrated that whenever the Messenger of Allah jg would recite, Vj o^Jjl 4Not (the way) of those who earned Your anger, nor of those who went astray>, He would say Amin until those who were behind him in the first line could hear him. 131 Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded this Hadith with the addition, "Then the Masjid would shake because of (those behind the Prophet jg) reciting Amin."141 Also, Ad-Daraqutni recorded this Hadith and commented that it is Hasan. Further, Bilal nan-ated that he said, "O Messenger ofAllah! Do not finish sayingAmin before I can join you."15 ' This was recorded byAbu Dawud.'61 In addition, Abu Nasr Al-Qushayri narrated that Al-Hasan and Jafar As-Sadiq stressed the 'm' in Amin. 111 Ahmad 4:315, Abu Dawud 1 :574, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 2 :67 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi2:67. Abu Dawud 1 :575. 141 Abu Dawud 1 :575, Ibn Majah 1 :279. Ad-Daraqutni 1 :335 Abu Dawud 1 :576.

1They will not envy us for anything more titan they envy us for Friday which we have been guided to, while they were led astray from it, and for the Qiblah which we were guided to, while they were led astray from it, and for our saying 'Amin behind the Imam .n* 11 Also, Ibn Majah recorded this Hadith with the wording. «The Jews have never envied you more than for your saying the Salam (Islamic greeting) andfor saying Amin.^2] 111 Ahmad 6:134 2| Ibn Majah 2:278.

Surah 2: Al-Baqarah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 95–103]

Opening Tafsirof SuratAl-Baqarah (Chapter 2)

The Virtues of SuratAl-Baqarah In Musnad Ahmad, Sahih Muslim, At- Tirmidhi and An- Nasa'i, it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, *«Do not turn your houses into graves. Verily, Shaytan does not enter the house where Surat Al-Baqarah is recited.»* At-Tirmidhi said, *«Hasan Sahih . Also, 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "Shaytan flees from the house where Surat Al-Baqarah is heard." This Hadith was collected by An-Nasa'i in Al-Yawm wal-Laylah , 121 and Al-Hakim recorded it in his Mustadrak, and then said that its chain of narration is authentic, although the Ahmad 2:284, Muslim 1 :539, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:180, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:13. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:13.*

Two Sahihis did not collect it. [11 In his Musnad, Ad-Darimi recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said, *«Shaytan departs the house where Surat Al-Baqarah is being recited, and as he leaves, he passes gas.»* Ad-Darimi also recorded that Ash-Shahi said that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, *«Whoever recites ten Ayat from Surat Al-Baqarah in a night, then Shaytan will not enter his house that night. (These ten Ayat are) four from the beginning, Ayat Al-Kursi (255), the following two Ayat (256-257) and the last three Ayat.»* In another narration, Ibn Mas'ud said, *«Then Shaytan will not come near him or his family, nor will he be touched by anything that he dislikes. Also, if these Ayat were to be recited over a senile person, they would wake him up.»*121 Further, Sahl bin Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah *jg* said, *«Everything has a hump (or, high peak), and Al-Baqarah is the high peak of the Qur'an . Whoever recites Al-Baqarah at night in his house, that Shaytan will not enter that house for three nights. Whoever recites it during a day in his house, then Shaytan will not enter that house for three days .»* This Hadith was collected by Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani, Abu Hatim Ibn Hibban in his Sahih and Ibn Mfirduwah.13' At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, *«The Messenger of Allah sent an expedition force comprising of many men and asked each about what they memorized of the Qur'an. The Prophet came to one of the youngest men among them and asked him, What have you memorized (of the Qur'an) young man?»* He said, *«I memorized such and such Surahs and also Al-Baqarah.»* The Prophet *jg* said, *«You memorized Surat Al-Baqarah?»* He said, *«Yes.»* The Prophet *ﷺ* said, *«Then you are their commander.»* One of the noted men (or chiefs) commented, *«By Allah! I did not learn Surat Al-Baqarah, for fear that I would not be able to 111 Al-Hakim 2:260. 121 Ad-Darimi 2 :322 At-Tabarani 6:163 and Ibn Hibban 2 :78.*

97 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) implement it. The Messenger of Allah said, . 1 aj ilsj \jii aaSm jlysJl Ji* ^ Ij^i . , > - . i.- . » > » « |> . > i • ' <_p>S cs? i>* JS <J, *>hj “4^;^ 6?->* v’j^ •* (iLearn Al-Qur'an and recite it, for the example of whoever learns the Qur'an, recites it and adheres to it, is the example of a bag that is full of musk whose scent fills the air. The example of whoever learns the Qur'an and then sleeps (i.e. lazy) while the Qur'an is in his memory, is the example of a bag that has musk, but is closed tight." This is the wording collected by At-Tirmidhi, who said that this Hadith is Hasan. In another narration, At-Tirmidhi recorded this same Hadith in a Mursal manner, so Allah knows best.' Also, Al-Bukhari recorded that Usayd bin Hudayr said that he was once reciting Surat Al-Baqarah while his horse was tied next to him. The horse started to make some noise. When Usayd stopped reciting, the horse stopped moving about. When he resumed reading, the horse started moving about again. When he stopped reciting, the horse stopped moving, and when he resumed reading, the horse started to move again. Meanwhile, his son Yahya was close to the horse, and he feared that the horse might step on him. When he moved his son back, he looked up to the sky and saw a cloud radiating with light that looked like lamps. In the morning, he went to the Prophet jg and told him what had happened and then said, “O Messenger of Allah! My son Yahya was close to the horse and I feared that she might step on him. When I attended to him and raised my head to the sky, I saw a cloud with lights like lamps. So I went, but I couldn’t see it.” The Prophet sg said, “Do you know what that was?” He said, “No.” The Prophet £g said, hi Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:186, An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubra 5:227, and Ibn Majah 1:78.

8 They were the angels, they came close hearing your voice (reciting Surat Al-Baqarah), and if you had kept reading, the people would have been able to see the angels when the morning came, and the angels would not be hidden from their eyes . »* 11 This is the narration reported by Imam Abu Ubayd Al-Qasim bin Salam in his book Fada’il Al-Qur’an. Virtues of Surat Al-Baqarah and Surat Al-Imran Imam Ahmad said that Abu Nu’aym narrated to them that Bishr bin Muhajir said that ‘Abdullah bin Buraydah narrated to him from his father, “I was sitting with the Prophet and I heard him say, 'jj UJU-i S'JLJl \ 8 Learn Surat Al-Baqarah, because in learning it there is blessing, in ignoring it there is sorrow, and the sorceresses cannot memorize itj He jg kept silent for a while and then said, fji jlJ jA> -j* L£jiS j\ jliiUJ-j*« S ay J—d (jrT ykiJl «iUJ o iji i .-iL>-Lk lit : ilLJl jJlk; JS ^ ikp •* ?;3 i'.-j y J5 jij 7 jliL>- ol.iJlj lJlijJl gf y*y ^Js- £-J>JJJ jklj • U5jJ jj-L : Jlili ?tju L™.S’ LL : *4l» t CjJI i olS l-i* \jZ U ^ ^4* 1 JU-klj iy ‘Learn Surat Al-Baqarah and Al-Imran because they are two lights and they shade their people on the Day of Resurrection, just as two clouds, two spaces of shade or two lines of (flying) birds. The Qur’an will meet its companion in the shape of a pale-faced man on the Day of Resurrection when his grave is opened. The Qur’an will ask him, 'Do you knco me?' The man will say, 7 do not know you.’ The Qur’an will say, 7 am your m Fath Al-Bari 8 :680

99 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) companion, the Qur'an, which has brought you thirst during the heat and made you stay up during the night. Every merchant has his certain trade. But, this Day, you are behind all types of trade.’ Kingship will then be given to him in his right hand, eternal life in his left hand and the croion of grace ivill be placed on his head. His parents will also be granted tivo garments that the people of this life could never afford. They ivill say, 'Why were we granted these garments?' It ivill be said, 'Because your son was carrying the Qur'an.' It ivill be said (to the reader of the Qur'an), 'Read and ascend through the levels of Paradise.’ He will go on ascending as long as he recites, whether

reciting slowly or quickly”¹¹¹ Ibn Majah also recorded part of this Hadith from Bishr bin Al-Muhajir, 12 and this chain of narrators is Hasan, according to the criteria of Imam Muslim. A part of this Hadith is also supported by other Hadiths. For instance, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Umamah Al-Bahili said that he heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, $\text{Jj } \backslash \% \text{ii ijyi i/tyi uu3i j* j\ jiiii lists' j\ 4jiiui. } \backslash \text{E}\backslash \text{s aali fa jet}$ ‘Read the Qur’an, because it will intercede on behalf of its people on the Day of Resurrection . Read the two lights, Al- Baqarah and Al ‘Imran, because they will come in the shape of two clouds, two shades or two lines of birds on the Day of Resurrection and will argue on behalf of their people on that Day .» The Prophet ﷺ then said, •ftkii is' , $\text{uii! oji Yj\text{,}\ \backslash \text{jY}\backslash \text{•}}$ «Read Al-Baqarah, because in having it there is blessing, and in ignoring there is a sorrow and the sorceresses cannot memorize »f.»¹³¹ m Ahmad 5:352 ^ Ibn Majah 2 :1242 131 Ahmad 5 :249

Also, Imam Muslim narrated this Hadith in the Book of Prayer Imam Ahmad narrated that An-Nawwas bin Sam‘an said that the Prophet ﷺ said, $\text{^jj jj JjLZm \jj[S yjj I aIaj yft'}$ •On the Day of Resurrection the Qur’an and its people who used to implement it will be brought forth, preceded by Surat Al-Baqarah and Al ‘Imran. An-Nawwas said, “The Prophet ﷺ set three examples for these two Surahs and I did not forget these examples ever since. He Eg said, $\text{2° h* . 4 lils' j\ i (3j** cjliU? j\ ; j iL. lists'! } \text{^>U? jp i}$ ‘They will come like two clouds, two dark shades or two lines of birds arguing on behalf of their people. It was also recorded in Sahth. Muslim ' and At-Tirmidhi narrated this Hadith, which he rendered Hasan Gharib . Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed in Al-Madinah There is no disagreement over the view that Surat Al- Baqarah was revealed in its entirety in Al-Madinah. Moreover, Al-Baqarah was one of the first Surahs to be revealed in Al- Madinah, while, Allah’s statement, j' , Cj> 4. And be afraid of the Day when you shall be brought back to Allah.) (2:281) was the last Ayah to be revealed from the Qur’an. Also, the Ayat about usury were among the last Ayat to be revealed. Khalid bin Ma’dan used to call Al-Baqarah the Fustat (tent) of Muslim 1 :553 ’ Ahmad 4:183 131 Muslim 1 :554. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:191

101 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) the Qur’an. Some of the scholars said that it contains a thousand news incidents, a thousand commands and a thousand prohibitions. Those who count said that the number of Al-Baqarah’s Ayat is two hundred and eighty-seven, and its words are six thousand two hundred and twenty-one words. Further, its letters are twenty-five thousand five hundred. Allah knows best. Ibn Jurayj narrated that ‘Ata’ said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed in Al-Madinah.”¹¹¹ Also, Khasif said from Mujahid that ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said; “Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed in Al-Madinah.”^{12*} Several Imams and scholars of Tafsir issued similar statements, and there is no difference of opinion over this as we have stated. The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn Mas‘ud kept the Ka’bah on his left side and Mina on his right side and threw seven pebbles (at the Jamrah) and said, “The one to whom Surat Al- Baqarah was revealed (i.e. the Prophet performed Rami (the Hajj rite of throwing pebbles) similarly.” The Two Sahihs recorded this Hadith^{S3} Further, Ibn Marduyah reported a Hadith of Shu’bah from ‘Aqil bin Talhah from Thabit bin Marthad; “The Prophet saw that his Companions were not in the first lines and he said, «rXJl Ojyl* U » “O Companions of Surat Al-Baqarah . » I Think that this incident occurred during the battle of Hunayn when the Companions retreated. Then, the Prophet ﷺ commanded Al-‘Abbas (his uncle) to yell out, OUwii Ul «0 Companions of the tree/» meaning the Companions who participated in the pledge of Ar-Ridwan (under the tree). In another narration, Al- ‘Abbas cried, “O Companions of Surat Al-BaqarahV’ encouraging them to come

back, so they returned from every direction. Also, during the battle of Al-Yamamah, against the army of Musaylimah the Liar, the Companions * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 1 :47. 121 Ibid. 131 Fath Al-B&ri3 :678 , Muslim 2 :942

first retreated because of the huge number of soldiers in Musaylimah's army. The Muhajirun and the Ansar called out for each other, saying; "O people of Surat Al-Baqarah\ " Allah then gave them victory over their enemy, may Allah be pleased with all of the companions of all the Messengers of Allah 4i— &^0p 4 i . ilti the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful 41. AlifLam Mim}. The Discussion ofthe Individual Letters The individual letters in the beginning of some Surahs are among those things whose knowledge Allah has kept only for Himself. This was reported from Abu Bakr, 'Umar, 'Uthman, 'Ali and Ibn Mas'ud. It was said that these letters are the names of some of the Surahs. It was also said that they are the beginnings that Allah chose to start the Surahs of the Qur'an with. Khaslf stated that Mujahid said, "The beginnings of the Surahs, such as Qaf, Sad, Ta Sin Mim and AlifLam Ra, are just some letters of the alphabet." Some linguists also stated that they are letters of the alphabet and that Allah simply did not cite the entire alphabet of twenty-eight letters. For instance, they said, one might say, "My son recites Alif, Ba, Ta, Tha..." he means the entire alphabet although he stops before mentioning the rest of it. This opinion was mentioned by Ibn Jarir. The Letters at the Beginning ofSurahs Ifone removes the repetitive letters, then the number of letters mentioned at the beginning of the Surahs is fourteen: Alif, Lam, Mim, Sad, Ra, Kdf, Ha, Yd, 'Ayn, Ta, Sin, Ha, Qaf, Nun. So glorious is He Who made everything subtly reflect His wisdom. Moreover, the scholars said, "There is no doubt that Allah did not reveal these letters for jest and play." Some ignorant 111 Al-Majma' 6:180. 121 At-Tabari 1 :208

103Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) people said that some of the Qur'an does not mean anything, (meaning, such as these letters) thus committing a major mistake. On the contrary, these letters carry a specific meaning. Further, if we find an authentic narration leading to the Prophet sg that explains these letters, we will embrace the Prophet's statement. Otherwise, we will stop where we were made to stop and will proclaim, 4 l>i Of 'A. 4We believe in it; all of it (clear and unclear verses) isfrom our Lord» (3 :7). The scholars did not agree on one opinion or explanation

regarding this subject. Therefore, whoever thinks that one

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scholar's opinion is correct, he is obliged to follow it, otherwise it is better to refrain from making any judgment on this matter. Allah knows best. These Letters testify to the Miraculous Qur'an The wisdom behind mentioning these letters in the beginning of the Surahs, regardless of the exact meanings of these letters, is that they testify to the miracle of the Qur'an. Indeed, the servants are unable to produce something like the Qur'an, although it is comprised of the same letters with which they speak to each other. This opinion was mentioned by Ar-Razi in his Tafsir who related it to Al-Mubarrid and several other scholars. Al-Qurtubi also related this opinion to Al-Farra' and Qutrub. Az-Zamakhshari agreed with this opinion in his book, Al-Kashshaf. In addition, the Imam and scholar Abu Al- 'Abbas Ibn Taymiyyah and our Shaykh Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Hajjaj Al-Mizzi agreed with this opinion. Al-Mizzi told me that it is also the opinion of Shaykh Al-Islam Ibn Taymiyyah. Az-Zamakhshari said that these

letters, “Were not all mentioned once in the beginning of the Qur’an. Rather, they were repeated so that the challenge (against the creation) is more daring. Similarly, several stories were mentioned repeatedly in the Qur’an, and also the challenge was repeated in various areas (i.e., to produce something like the Qur’an). Sometimes, one letter at a time was mentioned, such as Sad, Nun and Qaf. Sometimes two letters were mentioned, such as

——— Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4Ha Mutt} (44:1) Sometimes, three letters were mentioned, such as, 4f;^} iAlifLam Mim (2 :1)} and four letters, such as, 4‘AlifLdtn Mim Ra} (13:1), and iAlifLam Mini Sad} (7:1). Sometimes, five letters were mentioned, such as, 4KafHa Yd ‘Ayn Sad} (19:1), and; 4Ha Mutt. ‘Ayn Sin Qaf} (42:1-2). This is because the words that are used in speech are usually comprised of one, two, three, four, or five letters.” Every Surah that begins with these letters demonstrates the Qur’an’s miracle and magnificence, and this fact is known by those well-versed in such matters. The count of these Surahs is twenty-nine. For instance, Allah said, U t * *+ S iAlif Lam Mim} This is the Book (the Qur’an), wherein there is no doubt (2:1-2), 4*5&Q&2 *JS£4 '4 v 'if iAlifLam Mim. Allah! La ilahd ilia Huwa (mme has file right to be worshipped but He), Al-Hayyul-Qayyuum (the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists). It is He Who has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) to you (Multammad with truth, confirming what came before it.) (3:1-3), and, 44 cfZ- 4 jZ£ Jb'i If J£\} iAlifLam Mim Sad. (This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down

105Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) unto you (O Muhammad jg), so let not your breast be narrow therefrom} (7:1-2). Also, Allah said, i*-ifj jjLi V—• >> iAlif Lam Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you (O Muhammad 4g) in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness (of disbelief and polytheism) into the light (of belief in the Oneness ofAllah and Islamic Monotheism) by their Lord's leave (14:1), iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of the Book (this Qur’an) in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of the ‘Alamin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)!} (32:1-2), 4^*4\$ ci iHa Mim. A revelation from (Allah) the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful} (41:1-2), and, iHa Mim. 'Ain Sin Qdf. Likewise Allah, the Almighty, the W/se sends revelation to you (O Muhammad sg) as (He sent revelation to) those before you.} (42:1-3). There are several other Ayat that testify to what we have mentioned above, and Allah knows best. i2. That is Book in which there is no Rayb, guidance for the Muttaqin}. There is no Doubt in the Qur’an The Book, is the Qur’an, and Rayb means doubt. As-Suddi said that Abu Malik and Abu Salih narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, and Murrah Al-Hamadani narrated from Ibn Mas“ud and several other Companions of the Messenger of Allah that, i*i Cfj ^} Hn which there is no Rayb}, means about which there is no

doubt. 111 Abu Ad-Darda’, Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Nail' ‘Ata’, Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said similarly. In addition, Ibn Abi Hatim said, “I do not know of any disagreement over this explanation.”[2i The meaning of this is that the Book, the Qur’an, is without a doubt revealed from Allah. Similarly, Allah said in Surat As- Sajdah, iAlif Lam Mm}. The revelation of the Book (this Qur’an) in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists) (32:1-2). Some scholars stated that this Ayah - 2:2 - contains a prohibition meaning, “Do not doubt the Qur’an.” Furthermore, some of the reciters of the Qur’an pause upon reading, 4there is no doubt} and they then continue; iin which there is guidance far the Muttaqin (the pious and righteous persons)}. However, it is better to pause at,

ill iin which there is no doubt} because in this case, i<jj-e>} iguidance} becomes an attribute of the Qur'an and carries a better meaning than, / A ' i(SJL.t, jj) iin which there is guidance}. Guidance is granted to ThoseWho have Taqwa. Hidayah - correct guidance - is only granted to those who have Taqwa - fear of Allah. Allah said, At-Tabari 1 :228. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :3 1

jij wi i ^ —>-l-A 4-Uj? i>* -iijJj! c£-* - 4Sfli/: It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as far those ivho disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it (the Qur'an) is blindness for them. They are those who are calledfrom a place far azoay (so they neither listen nor understand)) (41:44), and, AT I, U / i * I / y » » »* W/»/x „•/ /> / \ Wi? send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe (in Islamic Monotheism and act on it), and it increases the Zdlimin (wrongdoers) in nothing but loss) (17:82). This is a sample of the numerous Ayat indicating that the believers, in particular, benefit from the Qur'an. That is because the Qur'an is itself a form of guidance, but the guidance in it is only granted to the righteous, just as Allah said, Cj Ski j j* i-WjA fS^CC- J3 J-U)' (\$k) iO mankind! There has come to you a good advice from your Lord (i.e. the Qur'an, enjoining all that is good and forbidding all that is evil), and a healing for that (disease of ignorance, doubt, hypocrisy and differences) which is in your breasts, - a guidance and a mercy (explaining lawful and unlawful things) for the believers) (10:57). Ibn 'Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg said, iguidance for the Muttaqm (the pious and righteous persons), means, a light for those who have Taqwa. The Meaning ofAl-Muttaqin Ibn 'Abbas said about.

^guidance for the Muttaqin} that it means, "They are the believers who avoid Shirk with Allah and who work in His obedience." Ibn 'Abbas also said that Al-Muttaqin means, "Those who fear Allah's punishment, which would result if they abandoned the true guidance that they recognize and know. They also hope in Allah's mercy by believing in what He revealed." Further, Qatadah said that, iAl-Muttaqin}, are those whom Allah has described in His statement; cgjity iWho believe in the Ghayb and perform the Salah (2:3), and the following Ayat. Ibn Jarir stated that the Ayah (2:2) includes all of these meanings that the scholars have mentioned, and this is the correct view. Also, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah narrated that 'Atiyah As-Sa'di said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *The servant will not acquire the status of the Muttaqin until he abandons what is harmless out offear of falling into that which is harmfulV At-Tirmidhi then said "Hasan Gharib." There areTwo Types of Hidayah (Guidance) Huda here means the faith that resides in the heart, and only Allah is able to create it in the heart of the servants. Allah said, If vA} 4Verily, you (O Muhammad jfe) guide not whom you like} (28:56), 4Not upon you (Muhammad jg) is their guidance (2:272), m TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :147 , and Ibn Majah 2 : 1409

109Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1 4/S (ill* iit £} ^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him} (7:186), and, /, / *£ /*" K ' < t. •> " ' cHr^ . v^~J Hi &T }He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly guided; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Walt (guiding friend) to lead him (to the right path)} (18:17). Huda also means to explain the truth, give direction and lead to it. Allah, the Exalted, said, d\ ^-£5 (Off} iAttd verily, you (O Muhammad sfe) are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight path (i.e. Allah's religion of Islamic Monotheism)} (42:52), iYou are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide} (13:7), and, itOi££\$& %} }And as for Thamiid, We showed and made

clear to them the path of truth (Islamic Monotheism) through Our Messenger (i.e. showed them the way of success), but they preferred blindness to guidance} (41:17). testifying to this meaning. Also, Allah said, iAnd shown him the two ways (good and evil).} (90:10) This is the view of the scholars who said that the two ways refer to the paths of righteousness and evil, which is also the correct explanation. And Allah knows best. Meaning of Taqwa The root meaning of Taqwa is to avoid what one dislikes. It was reported that Umar bin Al-Khattab asked Ubayy bin Ka*b about Taqwa. Ubayy said, “Have you ever walked on a path

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir that has thorns on it?” Umar said, “Yes.” Ubayy said, “What did you do then?” He said, “I rolled up my sleeves and struggled.” Ubayy said, “That is Taqwa.” 43. Those Who have faith in the Ghayb}. The Meaning of iman Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi said that Al-'Ala' bin Al-Musayyib bin Rafi' narrated from Abu Ishaq that Abu Al-Ahwas said that 'Abdullah said, “Iman is to trust.”. 1 11 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, iwho have faith means they trust.121 Also, Ma'mar said that Az- Zuhri said, “Iman is the deeds.”131 In addition, Abu Ja'far Ar- Razi said that Ar-RabT bin Anas said that, They have faith', means, they fear (Allah).,4) Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari) commented, “The preferred view is that they be described as having faith in the Unseen by the tongue, deed and creed. In this case, fear of Allah is included in the general meaning of iman, which necessitates following deeds of the tongue by implementation. Hence, Iman is a general term that includes affirming and believing in Allah, His Books and His Messengers, and realizing this affirmation through adhering to the implications of what the tongue utters and affirms.” Linguistically, in the absolute sense, Iman merely means trust, and it is used to mean that sometimes in the Qur'an, for instance, Allah the Exalted said, 4&p} it 4He trusts (yu'minu) in Allah , and trusts (yu'mittu) in the believers.} (9:61) Prophet Yusuf's brothers said to their father, At-Tabari 1 :235. Ibid. (31 Ibid. 4| Ibid.

4Buf yot/ u>i7/ never believe us even when we speak the truth> (12:17). Further, the word Iman is sometimes mentioned along with deeds, such as Allah said, 4o£i£ii \JSj ip: IM 4\} iSave those who believe (in Islamic Monotheism) and do righteous deeds (95:6). However, when iman is used in an unrestricted manner, it includes beliefs, deeds, and statements of the tongue. We should state here that Iman increases and decreases. There are many narrations and Hadlths on this subject, and we discussed them in the beginning of our explanation of Sahih Al-Bukhari, all favors are from Allah. Some scholars explained that iman means Khashyah (fear of Allah). For instance, Allah said; 4Verily, those who fear their Lord unseen (i.e. they do not see Him, nor His punishment in the Hereafter)} (67:12), and, iWho feared the Most Gracious (Allah) in the Ghayb (unseen) and brought a heart turned in repentance (to Him and absolutely free from every kind of polytheism)} (50:33). Fear is the core of Iman and knowledge, just as Allah the Exalted said, it is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah} (35:28). The Meaning of Al-Ghayb As for the meaning of Ghayb here, the Salaf have different explanations of it, all of which are correct, indicating the same '*' See the Tafstroi Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :35

general meaning. For instance, Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi quoted Ar- Rabi' bin Anas, reporting from Abu Al-'Aliyah about Allah's statement, i(Those who) have faith in the Ghayb}, “They believe in Allah, His angels, Books, Messengers, the Last Day, His Paradise, Fire and in the meeting with Him. They also believe in life after death and in Resurrection. All of this is the Ghayb.” Qatadah bin Di'amah said

similarly.¹¹ Said bin Mansur reported from ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Yazid who said, “We were sitting with ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud when we mentioned the Companions of the Prophet ﷺ and their deeds being superior to our deeds. ‘Abdullah said, The matter of Muhammad ﷺ was clear for those who saw him. By He other than Whom there is no God, no person will ever acquire a better type of faith than believing in Al-Ghayb.’ He then recited, iAlifLam Man. This is the Book, wherein there is no doubt, a guidance for the Muttaqin. Those who believe in the Ghayb}, until. 4the successful}. Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduwyah and Al- Hakim, in his Mustadrak,[13] recorded this Hadith. Al-Hakim commented that this Hadith is authentic and that the Two Shaykhs - Al-Bukhari and Muslim - did not collect it, although it meets their criteria. Ahmad recorded a Hadith with similar meaning from Ibn Muhayriz who said: I said to Abu Jumu’ah, “Narrate a Hadith for us that you heard from the Messenger of Allah.” He said, “Yes. I will narrate a good Hadith for you. Once we had lunch with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Abu TJBaydah, who was with us, said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Are people better than us? We embraced Islam with you and performed Jihad with you.’ He ﷺ At-Tabari 1 :236. ^ Said bin Mansur 2 :544 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :34 and Al-Hakim 2 :260.

113 Surah 2. Al-Bagaralt (1 - 24) (Part-1) said, ^ ^4^ ir! fj* r" «Yes, those who will come after you , who will believe in me although they did not see me.”” This Hadith has another route collected by Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah in his Tafsir, from Salih bin Jubayr who said: ‘Abu Jumu’ah Al-Ansari, the Companion of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, came to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem) to perform the prayer. Raja’ bin Haywah was with us, so when Abu Jumu’ah finished, we went out to greet him. When he was about to leave, he said, “You have a gift and a right. I will narrate a Hadith for you that I heard from the Messenger of Allah.” We said, “Do so, and may Allah grant you mercy.” He said, “We were with the Messenger of Allah, ten people including Mu’adh bin Jabal. We said, "O Messenger of Allah! Are there people who will acquire greater rewards than us? We believed in Allah and followed you.’ He jfe said, j: lyt p&OSi ife tri t* 1 ij-i L»j jjJUjoj j ijy’f iff. ly w>liS “What prevents you from doing so, while the Messenger of Allah is among you, bringing you the revelation from heaven? There are people who will come after you and who will be given a book between two covers (the Qur’an), and they will believe in it and implement its commands. They have a greater reward than you, even hoice as much.*’*2 / >..* i’ ’ ’n<\\ 4And perform Salah, and spend out of what we have provided for them} Meaning ofIqamatAs-Salah Ibn ‘Abbas said that, 111 Ahmad 4:106. ’ Ibn ‘Asakir 6 :368

114 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i.And perform the Salah\$, means, “Perform the prayer with all of the obligations that accompany it.” 1 11 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Iqamat As-Saldh means to complete the bowings, prostrations, recitation, humbleness and attendance for the prayer.”*2 ’ Qatadah said, “Iqamat As-Saldh means to preserve punctuality, and the ablution, bowings, and prostrations of the prayer. ”*3 Muqatil bin Hayyan said IqamatAs-Saldh means "To preserve punctuality for it, as well as completing ones purity for it, and completing the bowings, prostrations, recitation of the Qur’an, Tashahhud and blessings for the Prophet ﷺ. This is Iqamat As-Saldh.”*4 ’

The Meaning of“Spending” in thisAyah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 114–118]

'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, I- 'V 4And spend out of what We have provided for them means, "The Zakdh due on their wealth."5 As-Suddi said that Abu Malik and Abu Salih narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, as well as Murrah from Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions of the Messenger of Allah sg, that, iAnd spend out of what We have provided for them means, "A man's spending on his family. This was before the obligation of Zakdh was revealed."6 ' Juwaybir narrated from Ad-Dahhak, "General spending (in charity) was a means of drawing nearer to Allah, according to one's discretion and capability. Until the obligation of charity was revealed in the seven Ayat of Surat Bara'ah (chapter 9), were revealed. These abrogated the previous case."7' At-Tabari 1 :241 Ibid. ' Ibn AbiHStim 1:37. ' Ibid. At-Tabari 1 :243 6| Ibid. ' Ibid.

125Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) In many instances, Allah mentioned prayer and spending wealth together. Prayer is a right of Allah as well as a form of worshipping Him. It includes singling Him out for one's devotion, praising Him, glorifying Him, supplicating to Him, invoking Him, and it displays one's dependence upon Him. Spending is form of kindness towards creatures by giving them what will benefit them, and those people most deserving of this charity are the relatives, the wife, the servants and then the rest of the people. So all types of required charity and required spending are included in Allah's saying, iAnd spend out of ivhat we have provided for them}. The Two Sahlhs recorded that Ibn TJmar said that the Messenger of Allah said, flip liUJ bVj ib t ill i j{ jj. £ »o_Jl i »ljj|J ii'kSa}\ uIslam is built upon five (pillars): Testifying that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing the prayer, giving Zakah, fasting Ramadan and Hajj to the Housed There are many other Hadiths on this subject. The Meaning ofSalah In the Arabic language, the basic meaing of Salah is supplication. In religious terminology, Salah is used to refer to the acts of bowing and prostration, the remaining specified acts associated with it, specified at certain times, with those known conditions, and the characteristics, and requirements that are well-known about it. j** {j* Uj jIJJ L } 44 . And who have faith in what is revealed to you and in what ivas revealed before you, and in the Hereafter they are certain.} Ibn 'Abbas said that. *> I 1 * Fath Al-Bari 1 :64 and Muslim 1 :45.

116 Tafsir Ibtt Kathfr 4And who have faith in what is revealed to you and in what was revealed before you means, "They believe in what Allah sent you with, and in what the previous Messengers were sent with, they do not distinguish between (believing) them, nor do they reject what they brought from their Lord." 4And in the Hereafter they are certain^ that is the resurrection, the standing (on the Day of Resurrection), Paradise, the Fire, the reckoning and the the Scale that weighs the deeds (the Afizdn).*2 * The Hereafter is so named because it comes after this earthly life. Attributes ofthe Believers The people described here (2:4) are those whom Allah described in the preceding Ayah, 4Those who have faith in the Ghayb and perfortn Satdh, and spend out ofwhat we have providedfor them .) Mujahid once stated, "Four Ayat at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah describe the believers, two describe the disbelievers, and thirteen describe the hypocrites."*3 * The four Ayat mentioned in this statement are general and include every believer, whether an Arab, non-Arab, or a person of a previous Scripture, whether they are Jinns or humans. All of these attributes complement each other and require the existence of the other attributes. For instance, it is not possible that one believes in the Unseen, performs the prayer and gives Zakdh without believing in what the Messenger of Allah and the previous Messengers were sent with. The same with certainty in the Hereafter, this is not correct without that, for

Allah has commanded the believers, *xs\$ Jfj 4^.;&# 4' & ijU rp: sjf ^ 0 At-Tabari 1 :244. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :39. At-Tabari 1 :239.*

117Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) 40 you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger, and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has revealed to the Messenger, and the Book which He sent own to those before (him)) (4:136), *ait (L'C I+li \JSL iS^ If 41-S•(%^ t!4l4 i* And argue not with the People of the Book, unless it be in (a way) that is better, except with such of them as do wrong; and say (to them): "We believe in that which has been revealed to us and revealed to you; our Hah (God) and your Hah (God) is One (i.e. Allah)" (29:46), *ip* Li, \iJf Ciy ti \$&}* 40 you who have been given the Book (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed (to Muhammad ig) confirming what is (already) with you} (4:47), and, *oi 4 %M# & &p fo i* Say (O Muhammad \$&) : "O People of the Book (Jews and Christians)! You have nothing until you act according to the Tawrdlt (Torah), the Injil (Gospel), and what has (now) been revealed to you from your Lord (the Qur'an)." (5:68). Also, Allah the Exalted described the believers; *xi . > i • 4'>!r—J oi i* The Messenger (Muhammad believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between any of His Messengers" (2:285), and, *ipr?P r> !y^i Jij •A-'jj i i* And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them (Messengers)) (4:152),

This is a sample of the Ayat that indicate that the true believers all believe in Allah, His Messengers and His Books. The faithful among the People of the Book, have a special significance here, since they believe in their Books and in all of the details related to that, so when such people embrace Islam and sincerely believe in the details of the religion, then they will get two rewards. As for the others, they can only believe in the previous religious teachings in a general way. For instance, the Prophet stated. *Jit Iil» yOl Jjifj 01 Jjif <i* When the People of the Book narrate to you, neither reject nor affirm what they say. Rather, say, We believe in what was revealed to ns and what was revealed to i/om.)' However, the faith that many Arabs have in the religion of Islam as it was revealed to Muhammad sjfcj might be more complete, encompassing and firmer than the faith of the People of the Book who embraced Islam. Therefore, if the believers in Islam among the People of the Book gain two rewards, other Muslims who have firmer Islamic faith might gain an equal reward that compares to the two the People of the Book gain (upon embracing Islam). And Allah knows best. 45. They are on guidance from their Lord, and they are the successful. Guidance and Success are awarded to the Believers Allah said, *iThey are}* refers to those who believe in the Unseen, establish the prayer, spend from what Allah has granted them, believe in

what Allah has revealed to the Messenger and the Messengers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 118–125]

before him, believe in the Hereafter with certainty, and prepare the necessary requirements for the Hereafter by performing I 1 * Abu D&wud 4 :59.

119Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) good deeds and avoiding the prohibitions. Allah then said, *iiSJj* &}* 4On guidance} meaning, they are (following) a light, guidance, and have insight from Allah,

4And they are the successful meaning, in this world and the Hereafter. They shall have what they seek and be saved from the evil that they tried to avoid. Therefore, they will have rewards, eternal life in Paradise, and safety from the torment that Allah has prepared for rJj -&&& r iM# ^ z>JSy 'f i">1 it > s.' a 't ' >>i\" oX*~.juj 0_)«Jrr— His enemies. 46. Verily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe.} Allah said, 4& l\} 4Verily, those who disbelieve} meaning, covered the truth and hid it. Since Allah has written that they would do so, it does not matter if you (O Muhammad jg) warn them or not, they would still have disbelieved in what you were sent with. Similarly, Allah said, 'M ti ~

iTruly, those against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment (10:96-97). About the rebellious People of the Book, Allah said, m, \J4 u p; Ca^Ji iAnd even if you were to bring to the People of the Book (Jews and Christians) all the Ayat, they would not follow your Qiblah (prayer direction)} (2:5). These Ayat indicate that whomever Allah has written to be miserable, they shall never find anyone to guide them to happiness, and whomever Allah directs to misguidance, he shall never find anyone to guide him. So do not pity them - O Muhammad ^ - deliver the Message to them. Certainly, whoever among them accepts the Message, then he shall gain the best rewards. As for those who turn away in rejection, do not feel sad for them or concerned about them, for gif 01} iYour duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning} (13:40), and, iBut you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Wakil (Disposer of affairs, Trustee, Guardian) over all things} (11:12). 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, iVerily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you (O Muhammad warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe} "That the Messenger of Allah jg was eager for all the people to believe and follow the guidance he was sent with. Allah informed him that none would believe except for those whom He decreed happiness for in the first place, and none would stray except those who Allah has decreed to do so in the first

place.»m 4 v HJae. ±>\js. j^Jj &s J& Si* '^L) 47. Allah has set a seal on their hearts and on their hearing, and on their eyes there is a covering. Theirs will be a great torment Meaning of Khatama As-Suddi said that, 4Kluttama Allah means, "Allah has sealed."*21 Qatadah said that this Ayah means, "Shaytan controlled them when they obeyed him. Therefore, Allah sealed their hearts, hearing and sight, and they could neither see the guidance nor hear, comprehend or understand."13 * Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said, iAllah has set a seal on their hearts), "A stamp. It occurs when sin resides in the heart and surrounds it from all sides, and this submersion of the heart in sin constitutes a stamp, meaning a seal."141 Ibn Jurayj also said that the seal is placed on the heart and the hearing. [S * In addition, Ibn Jurayj said, that 'Abdullah bin Kathir narrated that Mujahid said, "The stain is not as bad as the stamp, the stamp is not as bad as the lock which is the worst type."16 * Al-A'mash said, "Mujahid demonstrated with his hand while saying, They used to say that the heart is just like this - meaning the open palm. When the servant commits a sin, a part of the heart will be rolled up - and he rolled up his index finger. When the servant commits another sin, a part of the heart will be rolled up' - and he rolled up another finger, until he rolled up all of his fingers. Then he At-Tabari 1:252. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :44 | 3i Ibid. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :44 At-Tabari 1 :259 161 Ibid.

223 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) authentic Hadith from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ stated. Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "When the believer commits a sin, a black dot will be engraved on his heart. If he repents, refrains and regrets, his heart will be polished again. If he commits more errors, the dots will increase until they cover his heart. This is the *Ran* (stain) that Allah described, 'But on their hearts is the *Ran* (stain) which they used to earn'" (83:14). At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah recorded this Hadith, and At-Tirmidhi said that it is *Hasan Sahih*. The Meaning of Ghishawah Reciting the Ayah, 'And Allah has set a seal on their hearts and on their hearing', then pausing, then continuing with, 'And on their eyes there is a Ghishawah (covering)' is accurate, for the stamp is placed on the heart and the hearing while the Ghishawah, the covering, is appropriately placed on the eyes. In his Tafsir, As-Suddi said that Ibn 'Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud said about Allah's statement, 'So that they neither understand nor hear. Allah also said that He placed a covering on their sight, meaning eyes, and so, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:254, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6:509, and Ibn Majah 2 :1418.

they do not see." I 1 ' The Hypocrites We mentioned that four Ayat in the beginning of Surat Al- Baqarah described the believers. The two last Ayat (2:6-7) describe the disbelievers. Afterwards, Allah begins to describe the hypocrites who show belief and hide disbelief. Since the matter of the hypocrites is vague and many people do not realize their true reality, Allah mentioned their description in detail. Each of the characteristics that Allah used to describe them with is a type of hypocrisy itself. Allah revealed Surat Bara'ah (chapter 9) and Surat Al-Munafiqun (chapter 63) about the hypocrites. He also mentioned the hypocrites in Surat An- Nur (24) and other Surahs, so that their description would be known and their ways and errors could be avoided. Allah said, 'And of mankind, there are some who say: "We believe in Allah and the Last Day" while in fact they do not believe'. They try to deceive Allah and those who believe, while they only deceive themselves, and perceive (it) not!} Meaning of Nifaq Nifaq means to show conformity - or agreement - and to conceal evil. Nifaq has several types: Nifaq in the creed that causes its people to reside in Hell for eternity, and Nifaq in deed, which is one of the major sins, as we will explain soon, Allah willing. Ibn Jurayj said of the hypocrite that, "His actual deeds are different from what he publicizes, what he conceals is different from what he utters, his entrance and presence are not the same as his exit and absence."*21 The Beginning of Hypocrisy The revelations about the characteristics of the hypocrites were revealed in Al-Madīnah, this is because there were no A(>Tabari 1 :266. 121 At-Tabari 1 :270.

hypocrites in Makkah. Rather the opposite was the situation in Makkah, since some people were forced to pretend that they were disbelievers, while their hearts concealed their faith. Afterwards, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ migrated to Al-Madinah, where the Ansar from the tribes of Aws and Khazraj resided. They used to worship idols during the pre-Islamic period of ignorance, just as the rest of the Arab idolators. Three Jewish tribes resided in Al-Madinah, Banu Qaynuqa'-allies of Al- Khazraj, Banu An-Nadlir and Banu Qurayzah-allies of the Aws. Many members of the Aws and Khazraj tribes embraced Islam. However, only a few Jews embraced Islam, such as 'Abdullah bin Salam. During the early stage in Al-Madinah, there weren't any hypocrites because the Muslims were not strong enough to be feared yet. On the contrary, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ conducted peace treaties with the Jews and several other Arab tribes around Al-Madinah. Soon after, the battle of Badr occurred and Allah gave

victory to Islam and its people. ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul was a leader in Al-Madinah. He was Al-Khazraj’s chief, and during the period of Jahiliyyah he was the master of both tribes - Aws and Khazraj. They were about to appoint him their king when the Message reached Al-Madinah, and many in Al-Madinah embraced Islam. Ibn Salul’s heart was filled with hatred against Islam and its people. When

the battle of Badr took place, he said, “Allah’s religion has

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 125–128]

become apparent.” So he pretended to be Muslim, along with many of those who were just like him, as well as many among the People of the Book. It was then that hypocrisy began in Al-Madinah and among the surrounding nomad tribes. As for the Emigrants, none of them were hypocrites, since they emigrated willingly (seeking the pleasure of Allah). Rather, when a Muslim would emigrate from Makkah, he would be forced to abandon all of his wealth, offspring and land; he would do so seeking Allah’s reward in the Hereafter. The Tafsir of Ayah 2:8 Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, ⁴ “And of mankind, there are some who say: “We believe in Allah and the Last Day” while in fact they do not believe ^

126 Tafsir Ibt Kathir “This refers to the hypocrites among the Aws and Khazraj and those who behaved as they did.” This is how Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi explained this Ayah. Allah revealed the characteristics of the hypocrites, so that the believers would not be deceived by their outer appearance, thus saving the believers from a great evil. Otherwise, the believers might think that the hypocrites were believers, when in reality they are disbelievers. To consider the sinners as righteous people is extremely dangerous, Allah said, ⁴ “And of mankind, there are some who say : “\Ne believe in Allah and the Last Day” while in fact they do not believe} meaning, they utter these false statements only with their tongues, just as Allah said, ⁴ “When the hypocrites come to you (O Muhammad M), they say: “\Ne bear witness that you are indeed the Messenger of Allah.” Allah knows that you are indeed His Messenger} (63:1). This Ayah means that the hypocrites utter these statements only when they meet you, not because they actually believe what they are saying. The hypocrites emphasize their belief in Allah and the Last Day with their words, when that is not the case in reality. Therefore, Allah stated that the hypocrites lie in their testimony of creed, when He said, ³ “And Allah bears witness that the hypocrites are indeed liars.” (63:1), and, ⁴ “\While in fact they believe not } Allah said, ¹ At-Tabari 1 :269

127 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) ¹ “They try to deceive Allah and those who believe}. The hypocrites show belief outwardly while concealing disbelief. They think that by doing this, they will mislead Allah, or that the statements they utter will help them with Allah, and this is an indication of their total ignorance. They think that such behavior will deceive Allah, just as it might deceive some of the believers. Similarly, Allah said, ¹ “On the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you. And they think that they have something (to stand upon). Verily, they are liars!” (58:18). Hence, Allah refuted their way by saying, ¹ “While they only deceive themselves, and perceive (it) not!” Allah stated that the hypocrites only deceive themselves by this behavior, although they are unaware of this fact. Allah also said, ¹ “\Verily, the hypocrites try to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them} (4:142). Also, Ibn Abi

Hatim narrated that Ibn Jurayj commented on Allah's statement, {Verily, the hypocrites seek to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them}, "The hypocrites pronounce, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah' seeking to ensure the sanctity of their blood and money, all the while concealing disbelief." 11 Said said that Qatadah said, CjjiKj (** Uj jSji Lilli S^ji} Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :46.

128 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4And of mankind, there are some who say : "We believe in Allah and the Last Day" while in fact they believe not. They try to deceive Allah and those who believe, while they only deceive themselves, and perceive (it) not! } "This is the description of a hypocrite. He is devious, he says the truth with his tongue and defies it with his heart and deeds. He wakes up in a condition other than the one he goes to sleep in, and goes to sleep in a different condition than the one he wakes up in. He changes his mind just like a ship that moves about whenever a wind blows." 11 ' 410. In their hearts is a disease and Allah luis increased their disease. A painful torment is theirs because they used to tell lies .}

The Meaning of 'Disease' in this Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 128–174]

As-Suddi narrated from Abu Malik and (also) from Abu Salih, from Ibn 'Abbas, and (also) Murrah Al-Hamdani from Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions that this Ayah, 4Jv 4In their hearts is a disease} means, 'doubt', and, 4^S-“ 4And Allah has increased their disease} also means 'doubt'.'2' Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and Qatadah also said similarly. ' *' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on, 4^ 4In their hearts is a disease}, "A disease in the religion, not a physical disease. They are the hypocrites and the disease is the 111 Ibn AbiHatim 1:47. | 2) At-Tabari 1 :280 '3 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :48

129 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) doubt that they brought to Islam. 4And Allah has increased their disease^ meaning, increased them in shameful behavior."111 He also recited, ^ j 0; tp: cty 4As /or Z/iouse zo/jo believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in zohose hearts is a disease, it will add disgrace to their disgrace.} (9:124-125) and commented, "Evil to their evil and deviation to their deviation." This statement by 'Abdur-Rahman is true, and it constitutes a punishment that is compatible to the sin, just as the earlier scholars stated. Similarly, Allah said, \ ^ iWhile as for those who accept guidance. He increases their guidance and grants them their piety} (47:17). Allah said next, 4Because they used to tell lies}. The hypocrites have two characteristics, they lie and they deny the Unseen. The scholars who stated that the Prophet knew the hypocrites of his time have only the Hadith of Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman as evidence. In it the Prophet jg gave him the names of fourteen hypocrites during the battle of Tabuk. These hypocrites plotted to assassinate the Prophet sg during the night on a hill in that area. They planned to excite the Prophet's camel, so that she would throw him down the hill. AllAh informed the Prophet sfe about their plot, and the Prophet Sfe told Hudhayfah their names. As for the other hypocrites, Allah said about them, >\ .I .."if i >s* > ':/ , » » ^ > / » /.< ^ At-Tabari 1 :280.

«/ was given the choice (to prayfor him or not), so I chose. » In another narration, the Prophet j|| said, "2/ I knew that by asking (Allah toforgive Ibn Saliil) more than seventy times that He would forgive

him, then I would do f/wf.n* 11 cyt j 'jJL—ii 't <3CSiS5 ^ jfi; 422. And ivhen it is said to them: "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: "We are only peacemakers " } 412. Verily, they are the ones who make mischief, but they perceive not.} Meaning of Mischief In his Tafsir, As-Suddi said that Ibn 'Abbas and Ibn MasYid commented, 4> Ci\ ijju jfjVl 4 'ji-ji v isj^ 4And when it is said to them : "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: "We are only peacemakers."} "They are the hypocrites. As for, 4j?W 4WL4 4 "Do not make mischief on tlie earth"}, that is disbelief and acts of disobedience. "2I Abu JaYar said that Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said that Abu AI-'Aliyah said that Allah's statement, 4 (*4! Jj 4And ivhen it is said to them: "Do not make mischief on the earth,"}, means, "Do not commit acts of disobedience on the earth. Their mischief is disobeying Allah, because whoever 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 184, Muslim 4 :2141 121 At-Tabari 1 :288.

disobeys Allah on the earth, or commands that Allah be disobeyed, he has committed mischief on the earth. Peace on both the earth and in the heavens is ensured (and earned) through obedience (to Allah). 1,(11 Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and Qatadah said similarly 2(Types of Mischief that the Hypocrites commit Ibn Jarir said, "The hypocrites commit mischief on earth by disobeying their Lord on it and continuing in the prohibited acts. They also abandon what Allah made obligatory and doubt His religion, even though He does not accept a deed from anyone except with faith in His religion and certainty of its truth. The hypocrites also lie to the believers by saying contrary to the doubt and hesitation their hearts harbor. They give as much aid as they can, against Allah's loyal friends, and support those who deny Allah, His Books and His Messengers. This is how the hypocrites commit mischief on earth, while thinking that they are doing righteous work on earth."131 The statement by Ibn Jarir is true, taking the disbelievers as friends is one of the categories of mischief on the earth. Allah said, Jf\ ^ tUi jz Mjl iAnd those who disbelieve are allies of one another, if you do not do this (help each other), there will be turmoil and oppression on the earth, and great mischief.> (8:73), In this way Allah severed the loyalty between the believers and the disbelievers. Similarly, Allah said, Pi 40 you who believe! Do not take disbelievers as Awliyid' (protectors or helpers or friends) instead of believers. Do you (1(Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :50. (2(Ibn Abi Hatim 1:51. •3| At-Tabari 1 :289

133 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) wish to offer Allah a manifest proof against yourselves?) (4:144). Allah then said, iVerily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depth of the Fire; no helper will you find for them) (4:145). Since the outward appearance of the hypocrite displays belief, he confuses the true believers. Hence, the deceitful behavior of the hypocrites is an act of mischief, because they deceive the believers by claiming what they do not believe in, and because they give support and loyalty to the disbelievers against the believers. If the hypocrite remains a disbeliever (rather than pretending to be Muslim), the evil that results from him would be less. Even better, if the hypocrite becomes sincere with Allah and makes the statements that he utters conform to his deeds, he will gain success. Allah said, 4And when it is said to them : "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: ,r \Ne are only peacemakers.") meaning, "We seek to be friends with both parties, the believers and the disbelievers, and to have peace with both parties." Similarly, Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4And when it is said to them: "Do not make mischief on the earth," they say: "Wc are only peacemakers") means, "We seek to make amends between the believers and the People of the Book." Allah said, ^ jU\$W) iVerily, they are the ones who make mischief, but they perceive not.). This Ayah

means that the hypocrites' behavior, and their claim that it is for peace, is itself mischief, although in their ignorance, they do not see it to be mischief. m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :52.

jtff\$ gas XT J^i £u XS \&i\$ Ji vsjj> 4\$&ES 4 j3j 413. And when it is said to them: Believe as the people believe," They say: "Shall we believe as the fools have believed?" Verily, they are the fools, but they do not know.} Allah said that if the hypocrites are told, 4ote> £li US' \£.*} i"Believe as the people believe,"}, meaning, 'Believe just as the believers believe in Allah, His angels, His Books, His Messengers, Resurrection after death, Paradise and Hellfire, etc. And obey Allah and His Messenger by heeding the commandments and avoiding the prohibitions.' Yet the hypocrites answer by saying, 4'S\$2i\ IT '\$£} i"Shall we believe as the fools have believed?"} they meant (may Allah curse the hypocrites) the Companions of the Messenger of Allah sg. This is the same Tafsir given by Abu Al-'Aliyah and As-Suddi in his Tafsir, with a chain of narration to Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and other Companions.¹¹¹ This is also the Tafsir of Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.¹²¹ The hypocrites said, "Us and them having the same status, following the same path, while they are fools?!" The fool' is the ignorant, simple-minded person who has little knowledge in areas of benefit and harm. This is why, according to the majority of the scholars, Allah used the term foolish to include children, when He said, 4&» -S3 ^ ajiiii lyjj }And do not give your property, which Allah has made a means of support for you, to the foolish} (4:5). Allah answered the hypocrites in all of these instances. For instance, Allah said here, £& v'> ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 1 :293. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 1 :294

135 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) iVerily, they are the fools}. Allah thus affirmed that the hypocrites are indeed the fools, yet, A&} iBut they know not}. Since they are so thoroughly ignorant, the hypocrites are unaware of their degree of deviation and ignorance, and such situation is more dangerous, a severer case of blindness, and further from the truth than one who is aware. £ & ijS. iSfc ! £«: 414. And when they meet those who believe, they say: "We believe," but when they are alone with their Shayatin (devils), they say: "Truly, we are with you; verily, we were but mocking."} 415. Allah mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to ivander blindly.} The Hypocrites* Cunning and Deceit Allah said that when the hypocrites meet the believers, they proclaim their faith and pretend to be believers, loyalists and friends. They do this to misdirect, mislead and deceive the believers. The hypocrites also want to have a share of the benefits and gains that the believers might possibly acquire. Yet, 4^1 ii!> 4But when they are alone with their Shayatin}, meaning, if they are alone with their devils, such as their leaders and masters among the rabbis of the Jews, hypocrites and idolaters. Human and Jinn Devils Ibn Jarir said, "The devils of every creation are the mischievous among them. There are both human devils and Jinn devils. Allah said,

136 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir 4And so We have appointed for every Prophet enemies - Shaydtfn (devils) among mankind and Jinn, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion (or by way of deception)} (6:1 12).

The Meaning of 'Mocking' Allah said, iThey say: "Truly, we are with you"}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah means, "We are with you, £ as} iVerily, we were but mocking}, meaning, we only mock people (the believers) and deceive them."¹¹¹ Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, ic,s.^£a\} iVerily, we were but mocking}, means, "We (meaning the hypocrites) were mocking the Companions of Muhammad."¹²¹ Also, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and Qatadah

said similarly. 131 Allah's statement. 4 4 re iifrA &} iAllah mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to wander blindly} answers the hypocrites and punishes them for their behavior. Ibn Jarir commented, "Allah mentioned what He will do to them on the Day of Resurrection, when He said, 40n the Day when the hypocrites - men and women - will say to the believers: "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light!" It will be said: "Go back to your rear! Then seek a At-Jabari 1 :300. Ibid. Ibid.

137Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) light!" So a wall will be put up between them, with a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it toill be torment.\$ (57:13), and, iAnd let not the disbelievers think that Our postponing of their punishment is goodfor them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness.} (3:178)." He then said, "This, and its like, is Allah's mockery of the hypocrites and the people of Shirk." The Hypocrites suffering for their Plots Allah stated that He will punish the hypocrites for their mockery, using the same terms to describe both the deed and its punishment, although the meaning is different. Similarly, Allah said, iTie recompense for an offense is an offense equal to it; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah} (42:40), and, iThen whoever transgresses (the prohibition) against you, transgress likewise against him} (2:194). The first act is an act of injustice, while the second act is an act of justice. So both actions carry the same name, while being different in reality. This is how the scholars explain deceit, cunning and mocking when attributed to Allah in the Qur'an. Surely, Allah exacts revenge for certain evil acts with a punishment that is similar in nature to the act itself. We should affirm here that Allah does not do these things out of joyful play, according to the consensus of the scholars, but as a just form of punishment for certain evil acts. Meaningof'Leavesthemincreasingintheirdeviationto wander blindly Allah said,

iAlldh mocks at them and leaves them increasing in their deviation to wander blindly). As-Suddi reported that Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas*ud and several other Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg said that. iand leaves them increasing^ means, He gives them respite. 111 Also, Mujahid said, "He (causes their deviation) to increase."12 Allah said; V i 4 pi \$& 1 <1\ jffE) 4Do they think that by the wealth and the children with which We augment them. (That) We hasten to give them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.) (23:55-56). Ibn Jarir commented, "The correct meaning of this Ayah is "We give them increase from the view of giving them respite and leaving them in their deviation and rebellion.' Similarly, Allah said, \$And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe in it thefirst time, and We shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly)." (6:1 10).*31 Tughyan used in this Ayah means to transgress the limits, just as Allah said in another Ayah, jSK- £ii& 6 iVerily, when the water Taghd (rose) beyond its limits, We carried you in the ship) (69:1 1). Also, Ibn Jarir said that the term 'Amah, in the Ayah means, 'deviation'. He also said about Allah's statement, 111 At-Tabari 1:311. 121 IbnAbiyatim 1:57. 131 At-Tabari 1 ;307

4^ 4in their deviation to wander "In the misguidance and disbelief that has encompassed them, causing them to be confused and unable to find a way out of it. This is because Allah has stamped their hearts, sealed them, and blinded their vision. Therefore, they do not recognize guidance or find the way out of their deviation.'" 1 ' o is *3it SSXst Sj 426. These are they who have purchased error with guidance, so their commerce was profitless. And they were not guided.} In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn

{Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud commented on; }These are they who have purchased error with guidance} saying it means, "They pursued misguidance and abandoned guidance." Mujahid said, "They believed and then disbelieved," while Qatadah said, "They preferred deviation to guidance." Qatadah's statement is similar in meaning to Allah's statement about Thamud, its® #£\$ iAnd as for Thamud, We granted them guidance, but they preferred blindness to guidance} (41:17). In summary, the statements that we have mentioned from the scholars of Tafsir indicate that the hypocrites deviate from the true guidance and prefer misguidance, substituting wickedness in place of righteousness. This meaning explains Allah's statement, iis\$imm& y iThese are they who have purchased error with guidance}, meaning, they exchanged guidance to buy misguidance. This meaning includes those who first believed, then later disbelieved, whom Allah described, IM Al-Tabari 1 :309.

p if * pr\ iThat is because they believed, and then disbelieved; therefore their hearts are sealed (63:3). The Ayah also includes those who preferred deviation over guidance. The hypocrites fall into several categories. This is why Allah said, iX \% 4So their commerce was profitless. And they were not guided>, meaning their trade did not succeed nor were they righteous or rightly guided throughout all this. In addition, Ibn Jarir narrated that Qatadah commented on the Ayah, rJj m&i t lifijlp ^ >3Vt 4So their commerce was profitless. And they were not guided>, "By Allah! I have seen them leaving guidance for deviation, leaving the Jama'ah (the community of the believers) for the sects, leaving safety for fear, and the Sunnah for innovation." * Ibn Abi Hatim also reported other similar statements.*2 j 3f CSS^ U ijCtf US feL'.i jSS' At-Tabari 1:316. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :60

ii&te ^ 417. Their likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire; then, when it illuminated all around him, Allah removed their light and left them in darkness. (So) they could not see}. 418. They are deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path).} The Example of the Hypocrites Allah likened the hypocrites when they bought deviation with guidance, thus acquiring utter blindness, to the example of a person who started a fire. When the fire was lit, and illuminitated the surrounding area, the person benefited from it and felt safe. Then the fire was suddenly extinguished. Therefore, total darkness covered this person, and he became unable to see anything or find his way out of it. Further, this person could not hear or speak and became so blind that even if there were light, he would not be able to see. This is why he cannot return to the state that he was in before this happened to him. Such is the case with the hypocrites who preferred misguidance over guidance, deviation over righteousness. This parable indicates that the hypocrites first believed, then disbelieved, just as Allah stated in other parts of the Qur'an. Allah's statement, 4Allah removed their light} means, Allah removed what benefits them, and this is the light, and He left them with what harms them, that is, the darkness and smoke. Allah said, 4And left them in darkness}, that is their doubts, disbelief and hypocrisy. 4(So) they could not see} meaning, they are unable to find the correct path or find its direction. In addition, they are, 4deaf} and thus cannot hear the guidance,

4dumb} and cannot utter the words that might benefit them, iand blind in total darkness and deviation. Similarly, Allah said, iVerily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind (22:46) and this why they cannot get back to the state of guidance that they were in, since they sold it for misguidance. *ijs" iX" <!)® *** ^>\ 4~&Jd iat JLi jJJ |i,i j^Lfci 429. Or like a rainstorm in the sky, bringing darkness, thunder, and lightning. They thrust their fingers in their ears to

keep out the stunning thunderclap for fear of death. But Allah ever encompasses the disbelievers. } 420. The lightning almost snatches away their sight, whenever it flashes for them, they walk therein, and when darkness covers them, they stand still. And if Allah willed. He could have taken away their hearing and their sight. Certainly, Allah has power over all things.} Another Parable of the Hypocrites This is another parable which Allah gave about the hypocrites who sometimes know the truth and doubt it at other times. When they suffer from doubt, confusion and disbelief, their hearts are, 4 Like a Sayyib}, meaning, "The rain", as Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, and several other Companions have confirmed it as well as in At-Tabari 1 :334.

143 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ata', Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas. Ad-Dahhak said "It is the clouds. However, the most accepted opinion is that it means the rain that comes down during, i.e. darkness meaning, here, the doubts, disbelief and hypocrisy. i.e. thunder that shocks the hearts with fear. The hypocrites are usually full of fear and anxiety, just as Allah described them, i.e. They think that every cry is against them (63:4), and, 4 (Uj *3) tyj) j' iLi'jLk i.e. They swear by Allah that they are truly of you while they are not of you, but they are a people who are afraid. Should they find refuge, or caves, or a place of concealment, they would turn straightway thereto in a swift rush} (9:56-57). i.e. The lightning}, is in reference to the light of faith that is sometimes felt in the hearts of the hypocrites, J-Ao-VJ* • i ' i.e. They thrust their fingers in their ears to keep out the stunning thunderclap for fear of death. But Allah ever encompasses the disbelievers}, meaning, their cautiousness does not benefit them because they are bound by Allah's all-encompassing will and decision. Similarly, Allah said, i.e. *y> • \K1r * .1? / »r; > pri'jj j? ^ UP® ^ 43 imj ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :66. 12! Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :67.

145 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) obvious and most correct view, and Allah knows best.' Consequently, on the Day of Judgment, the believers will be given a light according to the degree of their faith. Some of them will gain light that illuminates over a distance of several miles, some more, some less. Some people's light will glow sometimes and be extinguished at other times. They will, therefore, walk on the Sirat (the bridge over the Fire) in the light, stopping when it is extinguished. Some people will have no light at all, these are the hypocrites whom Allah described when He said, 'j—Jj 'fjy ut •iyil 35 & £> 40/1 the Day when the hypocrites - men and women - will say to the believers : "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light!" It will be said to them; "Go back to your rear! Then seek a light!") (57: 13). Allah described the believers, 'V? 'fjf |«*J> oo»jS isj i.e. On the Day you shall see the believing men and the believing women - their light running forward before them and by their right hands. Glad tidings for you this Day! Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)} (57:12), and, i>ri f*>j /*" lA' 4-*y» fjr 4-^=& ^ u j»-j1 4The Day that Allah will not disgrace the Prophet (Muhammad Sg) and those who believe with him. Their Light will run forward before them and (with their Records - Books of deeds) in their right hands. They will say: "Our Lord! Keep perfect our Light for us [and do not put it off till we cross over the Sirat (a slippery bridge over the Hell) safely] and grant us forgiveness. Verily, You are Able to do all things"} (66:8). Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :75.

commented on, i.e. Their Light will run forward before them}, "They will pass on the Sirat. according to their deeds. The light that some people have will be as big as a mountain, while the light of others will

be as big as a date tree. The people who will have the least light are those whose index fingers will sometimes be lit and extinguished at other times.”¹¹ Ibn Abi Hatim also reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Every person among the people of Tawhid (Islamic Monotheism) will gain a light on the Day of Resurrection. As for the hypocrite, his light will be extinguished. When the believers witness the hypocrite’s light being extinguished, they will feel anxious. Hence, they will supplicate, iOur Lord! Keep perfect our Light for us.”¹² * Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said, “On the Day of Resurrection, everyone who has embraced the faith will be given a light. When they arrive at the Sirat, the light of the hypocrites will be extinguished. When the believers see this, they will feel anxious and supplicate, iOur Lord! Keep perfect our Light for us.” Types of Believers and Types of Disbelievers Consequently, there are several types of people. There are the believers whom the first four Ayat (2:2-5) in Surat Al-Baqarah describe. There are the disbelievers who were described in the next two Ayat. And there are two categories of hypocrites: the complete hypocrites who were mentioned in the parable of the fire, and the hesitant hypocrites, whose light of faith is sometimes lit and sometimes extinguished. The parable of the rain was revealed about this category, which is not as evil as the first category. 111 At-Jabari 23:3179. 121 Al-Hakim 2:495.

149 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) lamp, a sealed heart with a knot tied around its seal, a heart that is turned upside down and a wrapped heart. As for the polished heart, it is the heart of the believer and the lamp is the light of faith. The sealed heart is the heart of the disbeliever. The heart that is turned upside down is the heart of the pure hypocrite, because he had knowledge but denied it. As for the wrapped heart, it is a heart that contains belief and hypocrisy. The example of faith in this heart, is the example of the herb that is sustained by pure water. The example of hypocrisy in it, is the example of an ulcer that thrives on puss and blood. Whichever of the two substances has the upper hand, it will have the upper hand on that heart*. This Hadith has a Jayid Hasan (good) chain of narration. Allah said, if He **** * >—**jl iif sti iAnd if Allah willed, He would have taken away their hearing and their sight. Certainly, Allah has power over all things}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statement, ^& i*i> iAnd if Allah willed. He would have taken away their hearing and their sight}, “Because they abandoned the truth after they had knowledge in it.” & if iCertainly, Allah has power over all things}. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah is able to punish or pardon His servants as He wills.”*2’ Ibn Jarir commented, “Allah only described Himself with the ability to do everything in this Ayah as a warning to the hypocrites of His control over everything, and to inform them that His ability completely encompasses them and that He is able to take away their hearing and sight.”*3’ Ibn Jarir and several other scholars of Tafsir stated that these two parables are about the same kind of hypocrite. So [1’ Ahmad 3:17. ’ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :76 ’ At-Jabari 1 :361

the ‘or’ mentioned in, 40r like a rainstorm froth ' rky} means ‘and’, just as the Ayah, 4 < ^ g %f 4And obey neither a c>- : isbeliever among them}. Therefore, ‘or’ in the Ayah inclu.i-)ice of using either example for the hypocrites. Also, M Qv. i said that ‘or’ means, “To show compatibility of the two ch,, res, just as when one says, ‘Sit with Al-Hasai. or Ibn Sirin.’ According to the view of Az-Zamakhshari, ‘so it means each of these persons is the same as the other, so you may sit with either one of them.’ The meaning of ‘or’ thus becomes ‘either.’ Allah gave these two examples of the hypocrites, because they both perfectly describe them.” I (Ibn Kathir) say, these descriptions are related to the type of hypocrite, because there is a difit r< nee between them as we stated. For instance, Allah mentioned

these types in Surat Bara'ah (chapter 9) when He repealed the statement, "And among them" three times, describing their types, characteristics, statements and deeds. So the two examples mentioned here describe two types of hypocrites whose characteristics are similar. For instance Allah gave two examples in Surat An-Nur, one for the advocates of disbelief and one for the followers of disbelief, He said, 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert} (24:39), until, '}} 4Or (the state of a disbeliever) is like the darkness in a vast deep sea} (24:40). The first example is of the advocates of disbelief who have complex ignorance, while the second is about the followers who have simple ignorance. Allah knows best. &4 * j. -Si P&4 pz

«jl iJUiat ill . O mankind! Worship your Lord (Allah), Who created you and those who were before you so that you may acquire Taqwd.i ill. WJw has made the earth a resting place for you, and the sky as a canopy, and sent down water (rain) from the sky and brought forth therewith fruits as a provision for you. Then do not set up rivals unto Allah (in worship) while you know (that He alone has the right to be worshipped) Tawhid Al-Uluhiyyah Allah next mentioned His Oneness in divinity and stated that He has favored His servants by bringing them to life after they did not exist. He also surrounded them with blessings, both hidden and apparent. He made the earth a resting place for them, just like the bed, stable with the firm mountains. iAnd the sky as a canopy^ meaning, 'a ceiling'. Similarly, Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd We have made the heaven a roof, safe and well-guarded. Yet they turn away from its signs (i.e. sun, moon, winds, clouds)i (21:32). i'&> »IU' iAnd sends down for you water (rain) from the sky> meaning, through the clouds, when they need the rain. Hence, Allah caused the various types of vegetation and fruits to grow as a means of sustenance for people and their cattle. Allah reiterated this bounty in various parts of the Qur'an. There is another Ayah that is similar to this Ayah (2:22), that is, Allah's statement, psz i&fr^ « J&5 ^=6 ^ n -jU. 'AS4JC3 p=45a 'ig ilt is He Wlw has made for you the earth as a dwelling place

and the sky as a canopy, and has given you shape and made your shapes good (looking) and has provided you with good things. That is Allah, your Lord, so Blessed be Allah, the Lord of all that exists (40:64). The meaning that is reiterated here is that Allah is the Creator, the Sustainer, the Owner and Provider of this life, all that is in and on it. Hence, He alone deserves to be worshipped, and no one and nothing is to be associated with Him. This is why Allah said next, iThen do not set up rivals unto Allah (in worship) while you know (that He alone has the right to be worshipped (2:22). The Two Sahihs record that Ibn Mashid said, "I said to the Messenger of Allah 3&, Which evil deed is the worst with Allah?" He said, «To take an equal with Allah, while He alone created you."'''111 Also, Mu'adh narrated the Prophet's statement, Aj IjS ojJUu ji 1a iSjOsU «Do you know Allah's right on His servants? They must worship Him alone and refrain from associating anything with Him in worshipV21 Another Hadith states, ni P 2>Uli U J&j X* iU) Jbl U iNone of you should say, 'What Allah and so-and-so person wills. Rather, let him say, 'What Allah wills, and then what so-and-so person wills. A Hadithwith the same Meaning Imam Ahmad narrated that Al-Harith Al-Ash'ari said that the Prophet of Allah jg said, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :350 and Muslim 1 :90. Fath Al-Bari 13:359 and Muslim 1 :59. 131 Ahmad 5:384, 394, 398.

'jf; l_r ->j»j <Ss- ^j5j jl Jf^t Jr'j'J 2)1 j!' J-r* A ji \S ^\j yg of J.jljj) <i>fj of Jci'r-!^ jitj j& Jiil of oUls i_r_L^ oj*f jj ifcj p^LUi of jj ^j ,_,>! u; : jiii ji liij ^4 -*jlj ji , j Ji'r-! 4Ai ji E^**j ^ ji J^JJ.1 2il jl :JU pi

tAf 2)1 .uAi kjjlil js. jJ>ii !•»*. -i> bA£*l Ji- <ol ji : j+ijf jf; pll~ ji ^-£j*P jij J^e-i ji oUK ^yp*' 'jj}'". Ji 'V- l5^' J»-j J4 j^i I llli <J Ijjii Vj s-*4 jf 'j—i p^jfi L g 3: " 41* iS^jiJ J**i wJ*i _ji e^AJaJ^ ^y»p • J» P^j—" Vj »jJ-pU 2)1 jp c vLUJL? _yp lj.iT.lj yS 'oli iljbj jj j aJLp A>*jJ 4 ^jJ l j.yq'.i 1 j^i £?J -p" (4^ Ji 4^4 Ji 1'j~p <** Jtj 4Ui j4 jli fliJl ^yAj .^iLLJl ^j J, jui xj. 4il ^LiJl ^ jp jJLjJl tj j\yjj2 tyji'j Jj. j\ <pj j-uJi pif jij jiis JjJj 'Jj jli jr^P *~ 2 (*^4 i£J£»f of j42 j* :j4J 4E, jij j-jj iui j*; jp 2>i /ju^p .ii£ iu » > __ t i , t ^ - j? 'JjN j-2j-'-4*i' <Jp j-2>4j llwr>- UJi>- ojji ^ Iplj- «2)l ^Si^ jlS' lil jUaJbl ayV//«/i commanded Yahya bin Zakariya to implement five commands and to order the Children of Israel to impletment them, but Yaltyd was slow in carrying out these commands. Isa said to Yahya, 'You were ordered to implement five commands and to order the Children of Israel to implement them. So either order, or I will do it.' Yahya said, 'My brother! I fear that ifyou do it before me, I will be punished or the earth will be shaken under my feet.' Hence, Yahya bin Zakariya called the Otildren of Israel to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), until they filled the Masjid. He sat on the balcony, thanked Allah and praised him and then said, 'Allah ordered me to implement five commandments and that I should order you to adhere to than. The first is that you worship Allah alone and

not associate any ivith Him. The example of this command is the example of a man who bought a servant from his money with paper or gold. The servant started to work for the master, but was paying the profits to another person. lA^io among you would like his servant to do that? Allah created you and sustains you. Therefore, worship Him alone and do not associate anything with Him. 1 also command you to pray, for Allah directs His Face towards His servant's face, as long as the servant does not turn away. So when you pray, do not turn your heads to and fro. I also command you to fast. The example of it is the example of a man in a group of men and he has some musk wrapped in a piece ofcloth, and consequently, all of the group smells the scent of the wrapped musk. Verily, the odor of the mouth ofa fasting person is better before Allah than the scent of musk. I also command you to give charity. The example of this is the example of a man who was captured by the enemy. They tied his hands to his neck and brought him forth to cut off his neck. He said to them, 'Can 1 pay a ransom for myselfo' He kept ransoming himself with small and large amounts until he liberated himself. I also command you to always remember Allah. The example of this deed is that of a man who the enemy is tirelessly pursuing. He takes refiige in a fortified fort. When the servant remembers Allah, he will be resorting to the best refugefrom Satan . Al-Harith then narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, j apUoJl j ip a&p Ij* gfo- is j~Z jJ ipli>Jl j* -«ul ill dfoj li yi* ^ Ifij ^ l^piU ijt pj j (C>'j jp» :Jlii jlj •ill sUp 'fo ill j> (>Ip •And / order you with five commandments that Allah has ordered me. Stick to the Jamd'ah (community of the faithfid), listen and obey (your leaders) and perform Hijrah (migration) and Jihad for the sake ofAllah. Whoever abandons the Jamd'ah, even the distance of a hand span, will have removed tlte tie of Islam from his neck, unless he returns. Wlwever uses the

slogans of Jahiliyah (the pv' '•.mic period of ignorance) he Will be among those kneeling in >rJiannam (Hellfire) .» They saki "O Messenger of Allah! F • ' i if he prays and fasts?" He said, «Evcn ifhe prays, fasts and claims to be Muslim. So call the Muslims with their i. < that Allah has called them : 'The Muslims, the believing sl'». \ /s ofAllah. This is a Hasan Hadith, >nd it contains the statement, "Allah has created and sustain;; you, so worship Him and do not associate anything with Him in worship." This statement is relevant in the Ayat (2:2 -22) we are discussing here and supports singling Allah in worship, without partners. Signs ofAllah's Existence Several scholars of Tafsir, like Ar-Razi and others,

used these Ayat as an argument for the existence of the Creator, and it is a most worthy method of argument. Indeed, whoever ponders over the things that exist, the higher and lower creatures, their various shapes, colors, behavior, benefits and ecological roles, then he will realize the ability, wisdom, knowledge, perfection and majesty of their Creator. Once a bedouin was asked about the evidence to Allah's existence, he responded, "All praise is due to Allah! The camel's dung testifies to the existence of the camel, and the track testifies to the fact that someone was walking. A sky that holds the giant stars, a land that has fairways and a sea that has waves, does not all of this testify that the Most Kind, Most Knowledgeable exists?"¹²¹ Hence, whoever gazes at the sky in its immensity, its expanse, and the various kinds of planets in it, some of which appear stationary in the sky - whoever gazes at the seas that surround the land from all sides, and the mountains that were placed on the earth to stabilize it, so that whoever lives on land, whatever their shape and color, are able to live and thrive - whoever reads Allah's statement, *يٰۤاَيُّهَا الَّذِيْنَ اٰمَنُوْا اذْكُرْ اَنَّهُٓ هُوَ الَّذِيْ خَلَقَ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضَ وَجَعَلَ لَكُمُ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضَ نَافِلَتًا لَّكُمۡ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُوْنَ* Ahmad 4:130. ¹²¹ Razi 2:91.

257 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) Our servant^ meaning, Muhammad *ﷺ*, 4} then produce a Surah (chapter)} meaning, similar to what he brought to you. Hence, if you claim that what he was sent with did not come from Allah, then produce something similar to what he has brought to you, using the help of anyone you wish instead of Allah. However, you will not be able to succeed in this quest. Ibn 'Abbas said that, *your witnesses* means "Aids."¹¹¹ Also, As-Suddi reported that Abu Malik said the Ayah means, "Your partners, meaning, some other people to help you in that. Meaning then go and seek the help of your deities to support and aid you."¹²¹ Also, Mujahid said that, *and call your witnesses* means, "People, meaning, wise and eloquent men who will provide the testimony that you seek."³ The Challenge Allah challenged the disbelievers in various parts of the Qur'an. For instance, Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas (28:49), *Wa ja'ill (ja' iSay (to them, O Muhammad : "Then bring a Book from Allah, which is a better guide than these two (the Tawrdh (Torah) and the Qur'an), that I may follow it, if you are truthful")*. Also, Allah said in Surat Al-Isra' (17:88), *Stf £&A\$ * && u£ ift ol £y\j +Z2 £ J} 4Say :* "If mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could not produce the like thereof, even At-Tabari 1 :376. '2| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :84 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :85

159 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) is the Tafsir of "Umar, Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and the majority of the scholars. And he gave preference to this view and mentioned the fact that Allah has challenged the disbelievers as individuals and as groups, whether literate or illiterate, thus making the challenge truly complete. This type of challenge is more daring than simply challenging the disbelievers who might not be literate or knowledgeable. This is why Allah said, *Bring you then ten forged Surahs (chapters) like it> (11:13), and, iThey could not produce the like thereof^ (17:88)*. Therefore, this is a general challenge to the Arab disbelievers, the most eloquent among all nations. Allah challenged the Arab disbelievers both in Makkah and Al-Madlnah several times, especially since they had tremendous hatred and enmity for the Prophet *ﷺ* and his religion. Yet, they were unable to succeed in answering the challenge, and this is why Allah said, *But if you do it not, and you can never do it), indicating that they will never be able to answer the challenge*. This is another miracle, in that, Allah clearly stated without doubt that the Qur'an will never be opposed or challenged by anything similar to it, for eternity. This is a true statement that has not been changed until the present and shall never change. How can anyone be able to produce something like the Qur'an, when the Qur'an is the Word of Allah Who created everything? How can the words of the created ever be similar to the Words

of the Creator? Examples of the Miracle of the Qur'an Whoever reads through the Qur'an will realize that it contains various levels of superiority through both the apparent and hidden meanings that it mentions. Allah said, [^]j. iii 2 £i:

iAlifLam Ra. (This is) a Book, the verses whereof are perfect (in every sphere of knowledge, etc.), and then explained in detail from One (Allah), Who is Wise and well-acquainted (with all things)} (11:1) So the expressions in the Qur'an are perfect and its meanings are explained. Further, every word and meaning in the Qur'an is eloquent and cannot be surpassed. The Qur'an also mentioned the stories of the people of the past; and these accounts and stories occurred exactly as the Qur'an stated. Also, the Qur'an commanded every type of righteousness and forbade every type of evil, just as Allah stated, \iJLg c*Cj iAnd the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). meaning, true in the stories it narrates and just in its Laws. The Qur'an is true, just and full of guidance. It does not—contain exaggerations, lies or falsehood, unlike Arabic and other types of poems that contained lies. These poems, conform with the popular statement, “The most eloquent speech is the one that contains the most lies!” Sometimes, one would find a long poem that mainly contains descriptions of women, horses or alcohol. Or, the poem might contain praise or the description of a certain person, horse, camel, war, incident, fear, lion, or other types of items and objects. Such praise or descriptions do not bring any benefit, except shed light on the poet's ability to clearly and eloquently describe such items. Yet, one will only be able to find one or two sentences in many long poems that elaborate on the main theme of the poem, while the rest of the poem contains insignificant descriptions and repetitions. As for the Qur'an, it is entirely eloquent in the most perfect manner, as those who have knowledge in such matters and understand Arabic methods of speech and expressions concur. When one reads through the stories in the Qur'an, he will find them fruitful, whether they were in extended or short forms, repeated or not. The more these stories are repeated, the more fruitful and beautiful they become. The Qur'an does not become old when one repeats reciting it, nor do the scholars ever get bored with it. When the Qur'an mentions the subject

161 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) of warning and promises, it presents truths that would make solid, firm mountains shake, so what about the comprehending, understanding hearts? When the Qur'an promises, it opens the hearts and the ears, making them eager to attain the abode of peace - Paradise - and to be the neighbors of the Throne of the Most Beneficent. For instance, on the subject of promises and encouragement, the Qur'an said, Uj »]•». j£» cit\$ ^ 4No person knows what is kept hidden for them of joy as a reward for what they used to do} (32:17), and, »"/y l^t V 4(There will be) therein all that inner selves could desire, and all that eyes could delight in and you will abide therein forever} (43:71). On the subject of warning and discouragement; viC 'f-> o' } 4Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up} (17:68), and, O' tU-J' r ' 4f ' ; jju OyUJt \ - 4Do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake? Or do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send against you a violent whirlwind? Then you shall know how (terrible) has been My warning} (67:16-17). On the subject of threats, the Qur'an said, 4So We punished each (of them) for his sins} (29:40). Also, on the subject of soft advice, the Qur'an said,

iTell Me, (even) if We do let them enjoy for years. And afterwards comes to them that (punishment) - which they had been promised. All that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them (26:205-207). There are many other examples of the eloquence, beauty, and benefits of the Qur'an. When the Qur'an is discussing Laws, commandments and prohibitions, it commands every type of righteous, good, pleasing and beneficial act. It also forbids every type of evil, disliked and amoral act. Ibn Mas'ud and other scholars of the Salaf said, "When you hear what Allah said in the Qur'an, such as, *يا أيها الذين آمنوا* {O you who believe!}, then listen with full attention, for it either contains a type of righteousness that Allah is enjoining, or an evil that He is forbidding." For instance, Allah said, *يا أيها الذين آمنوا أوفوا بالعقود* (He (Muhammad s& commands them for Al-Ma'ruf (i.e. Islamic Monotheism and all that Islam has ordained); and forbids them from Al-Munkar (i.e. disbelief, polytheism of all kinds, and all that Islam has forbidden); he allows them as lawful At-Tayyibat (i.e. all good and lawful things), and prohibits them as unlawful Al-Khaba'ith (i.e. all evil and unlawful things), he releases them from their heavy burdens and from the fetters (bindings) that were upon them} (7:157). When the Ayat mention Resurrection and the horrors that will occur on that Day, and Paradise and the Fire and the joys and safe refuge that Allah prepared for His loyal friends, or torment and Hell for His enemies, these Ayat contain glad tidings or warnings. The Ayat then call to perform good deeds and avoid evil deeds, making the life of this world less favorable and the Hereafter more favorable. They also establish the correct methods and guide to Allah's straight path and just legislation, all the while ridding the hearts of the evil of the cursed devil.

163 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (1 - 24) (Part-1) The Qur'an is the Greatest Miracle given to the Prophet The Two Sahih records that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, *لأنني أنزلني القرآن في ليلة القدر* "Even/ Prophet was given a miracle, the type of which brings mankind to faith. What I was given is a revelation that Allah sent down to me. Yet, I hope that I will have the most following on the Day of Resurrection This is the wording narrated by Muslim. The Prophet stated that among the Prophets he was given a revelation, meaning, he was especially entrusted with the miraculous Qur'an that challenged mankind to produce something similar to it. As for the rest of the divinely revealed Books, they were not miraculous according to many scholars. Allah knows best. The Prophet was also aided with innumerable signs and indications that testify to the truth of his prophethood and what he was sent with, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. Meaning of 'Stones' Allah said, *ثم فاعلموا أن النار أشد حرارة من حطبها* (Then fear the Fire (Hell) whose fuel is men and stones, prepared for the disbelievers) (2:24). 'Fuel' is wood, or similar substances, used to start and feed a fire. Similarly, Allah said, *وإن من دابة إلا نحن فاعلموا أن النار أشد حرارة من حطبها* (And as for the Qodsitun (disbelievers who deviated from the right path), they shall be fuel for Hell) (72:15), and, *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْإِنسَانُ لِرَبِّهِمْ كَذَّابٌ* (O AS. a~f~ s— oi \aj +Z=K>f Ijj t U cifi 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :619 and Muslim 1 :134

164 Tafstr Ibn Kathir • {Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell! (Surely) you enter it. Had these (idols) been deities (gods), they would not have entered there (Hell), and all of them will abide therein} (21:98-99). The stones mentioned here are the giant, rotten, black, sulfuric stones that become the hottest when heated, may Allah save us from this evil end. It was also reported that the stones mentioned here are the idols and rivals that were worshipped instead of Allah, just as Allah said, *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْإِنسَانُ لِرَبِّهِمْ كَذَّابٌ* (Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell!) (21:28). Allah's statement, *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّمَا الْإِنسَانُ لِرَبِّهِمْ كَذَّابٌ* It appears most obvious that it refers to the Fire that is fueled by men and

stones, and it also may refer to the stones themselves. There is no contradiction between these two views, because they are dependent upon each other. 'Prepared' means, it is 'kept' and will surely touch those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messenger Ibn Ishaq narrated that Muhammad said that *Ikrimah or Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said, ipreparedfar the disbelievers}, "For those who embrace the disbelief that you (disbelievers) have embraced. " * 1 ' Jahannam (Hellfire) existsnow Many of the Imams of the Sunnah used this Ayah to prove that the Fire exists now. This is because Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 1:383.

4prepared^ meaning, prepared and kept. There are many Hadiths on this subject. For instance, the Prophet jg said. "Paradise and the Fire had an argument . Also, the Prophet% said, :0="s~; ^ 'r'J 1*3 jlill "The Fire sought the permission ofher Lord. Site said, 'O my Lord! Some parts of me consumed the other parts.' And Allah allowed her two periods to exhale, one in winter and one in summer. » Also, there is a Hadith recorded from Ibn Mas*ud that the Companions heard the sound of a falling object. When they asked about it, the Messenger of Allah sfe said, «Uy<i jSfl -k* j£~“ Crt ii “This is a stone that was thrown from the top of Jahannam seventy years ago, but only now reached its bottom .» This Hadith is in Sahih Muslim. 131 There are many Hadiths that are Mutawatir (narrated by many different chains of narrations) on this subject, such as the Hadiths about the eclipse prayer, the night of /srd' etc. Allah's statements, iThen produce a Surah (chapter) of the like thereof^ (2:23), and, 4'i& 4A Surah (chapter) like ify (10:38) this includes the short and long Surahs of the Qur'an. Therefore, the challenge to creation stands with regards to both the long and short Surahs, and Muslim 4 :2186. Al-Bukhari no . 527, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :317 131 Muslim 4:2184.

166 Tafstr Ibn Kathir there is disagreement that I ' ' know of on this fact between the scholars ^x "> f>4 i-'i. > - rLsfc*. of old and new. Before he beame Muslim. Amr bin Al-'As met .*<' s x •' \ •' Musaylimah the Liar who asked him, "What has recently S<1 , x - \ -i Musaylimah the Liar who asked him, "what has recently /, . been revealed to your aiiBUiU^ >£=>dyJ'UijjL^J fellow (meaning >\ .- Nll'i'v," Muhammad s§) in Amr said, Xjr-Sj^-^tf ^ dn» , 'J ->*' "A short, yet eloquent < >\--" -l 't Surah." He asked, iW^oy' ah' "What is it?" He said, J &tf Si >jdiL^ 4By Al-'Asr (the time). aotfi'T Musaylimah J thought for a while and said, "A similar Surah was also revealed to me." 'Amr asked, "What is it?" He said, "O Wabr, O Wabr (i.e. a wild cat), you are but two ears and a chest, and the rest of you is unworthy and thin." 'Amr said, "By Allah! You know that I know that you are lying." IU= j&Vf <& 3 iju£j \JX £j& JZ> l\$J 'ti 15*15 J-5 Oi ufj' 'Ly Ar—j ^ l^V ^ t!*; (L*j ^25. And give glad tidings to those who believe and do righteous good deeds, tluit for them will be Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise). Every time they will be provided with a fruit therefrom, they will say: "This is what we were provided with before," and they ivill be given things in

167Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) resemblance (i.e. in the same form but different in taste) and they shall have therein Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates or wives), and they will abide therein forever Rewards ofRighteous Believers After mentioning the torment that Allah has prepared for His miserable enemies who disbelieve in Him and in His Messengers, He mentions the condition of His happy, loyal friends who believe in Him and in His Messengers, adhere to the faith and perform the good deeds. This is the reason why the Qur'an was called Mathani, based on the correct opinion of the scholars. We will elaborate upon this subject later. Mathani means to mention faith and then disbelief,

or vice versa. Or, Allah mentions the miserable and then the happy, or vice versa. As for mentioning similar things, it is called Tashabbuh, as we will come to know, Allah willing. Allah said, iAnd give glad tidings to those who believe and do righteous good deeds, that for them will be Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)^. Consequently, Allah stated that Paradise has rivers that run beneath it, meaning, underneath its trees and rooms. From Hadiths it is learned that the rivers of Paradise do not run in valleys, and that the banks of Al-Kawthar (the Prophet's lake in Paradise) are made of domes of hollow pearls, the sand of Paradise is made of scented musk while its stones are made from pearls and jewels. We ask Allah to grant Paradise to us, for verily, He is the Most Beneficent, Most Gracious. Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, Jv 1 *- ...1 1 Q.>W ^jA «The rivers of Paradise spring from beneath hills, or mountains of musk . ,1! He also reported from Masruq that 'Abdullah said, "The rivers of Paradise spring from beneath mountains of musk. "21 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :87. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :88

269 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) The Wives of the People of Paradise are Pure Allah said. iand they shall have therein Azwajun Mutahharatun}. Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Purified from filth and impurity."1 11 Also, Mujahid said, "From menstruation, relieving the call of nature, urine, spit, semen and pregnancies."121 Also, Qatadah said, "Purified from impurity and sin." In another narration, he said, "From menstruation and pregnancies."131 Further, 'Ata', Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih, 'Atiyah and As-Suddi were reported to have said similarly. Allah's statement, iand they will abide therein forever^ meaning ultimate happiness, for the believers will enjoy everlasting delight, safe from death and disruption of their bliss, for it never ends or ceases. We ask Allah to make us among these believers, for He is the Most Generous, Most Kind and Most merciful. ** IXfj iii i'j' 'iC iri ^ jilf oyiajc, jiy «Aj iif ^1 Vi jyJaOJ -A.j.'j .4 JILu 426 . Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger (or less when it is smaller) than it. And as for those who believe, they know that it is the truth from their Lord, but as for those who disbelieve, they say : "What did Allah intend by this parable?" By it He misleads many, and many He guides thereby. And He misleads thereby only the Fdsiqin (the rebellious, disobedient to 111 At-Tabari 1 :295. At-Tabari 1 :396. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:91. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :92

Allah). 427. Those who break Allah's covenant after ratifying it, and sever what Allah has ordered to be joined and do mischief on earth, it is they xoho are the losers.) In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud, and some Companions said; "When Allah gave these two examples of the hypocrites" meaning Allah's statements, -^ iTheir likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire), and, }) iOr like a rainstorm from the sky), "The hypocrites said, 'Allah's far more exalted than for Him to make such examples.' So Allah revealed these Ayat (2:26-27) up to: iWlto are the losers)".111 Said said that Qatadah said, "Allah does not shy away from the truth when He mentions a matter as a parable, whether this matter is significant or not. When Allah mentioned the flies and the spider in His Book, the people of misguidance said, *Why did Allah mention these things.' So Allah revealed; 4Verily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger (or less when it is smaller) than A Parable about the Life of This World Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi reported that Ar-Rabl' bin Anas commented on this Ayah (2:26); "This is an example that Allah has given for the life of this world. The mosquito lives as long as it needs food, but when it gets fat, it dies.

This is also the example of people whom Allah mentioned in the Qur'an: when At-Tabari 1 :398. At-Tabari 1 :399.

171 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) they acquire (and collect the delights of) the life of this world, Allah then takes them away." Afterwards, he recited, 4», *y. 'A 1 4 So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of every (pleasant) thing) (6:44)' In this Ayah (2:26) Allah stated that He does not shy away or hesitate in making an example or parable of anything, whether the example involves a significant or an insignificant matter. Allah's statement, iOr so much more when it is bigger than it) Fama fawqaha means, something bigger than the mosquito, which is one of the most insignificant and tiniest of creatures. Muslim narrated that Aishah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, il & i* 2 VI ui isfo ill: -ill *No Muslim is harmed by a thorn, Fama fawqaha (or something larger), but a good deed will be written for him and an evil deed will be erased from his record .»[2] So Allah has informed us that there is no matter that is too small that is exempt from being used as an example, even if it was as insignificant as a mosquito or a spider. Allah said, 40 mankind! A similitude has been coined, so listen to it (carefully) : Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create (even) a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from 111 At-Tabari 1 :398. ' Muslim 4:1991.

them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are (both) the seeker and the sought.} (22:73), o!j 1% ojjif ^ <g>S> Jt lAicf \$£} 4 }} •; ji Ojlfetijl? C-4 Ojlilf 477i^ likeness of those who take (false deities as) Awliya' (protectors, helpers) other than Allah is the likeness of a spider who builds (for itself) a house; but verily, the frailest (weakest) of houses is the spider's house - if they but knew .)> (29:41), and, a <*>^ liU -fS £3, £i?& ^ of >- JW/'" *»• —1-v^j Lfj; oil, J£^ lli£ »1 gj; j; l- 4^* 3>» oj oW JIJ? J-4VJ —,3j Qjl' sj?^' J vli^V (A** iif i*4< '^->*4 c "if££ sairf Si 4 See you not how Allah sets forth a parable? A goodly word as a goodly tree, whose root is firmly fixed, and its branches (reach) to the sky (i.e. very high). Giving its fruit at all times, by the leave of its Lord, and Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember. And the parable of an evil ivord is that of an evil tree uprooted from the surface of earth, having no stability. Allah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in life of this world (i.e. they will keep on worshipping Allah alone and none else), and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers) to go astray those and Allah does what He wills.} (14:24-27). Allah said, x v * v .1 1 /•' »•" >i< , 4 », c* j-M* V SJua '_u* OLI* *a' ~ iAllah puts forward the example of (two men - a believer and a disbeliever); a servant under the possession of another, he has no power of any sort} (16:75). He then said, & J^=>» tLaJul X* 4J1I ^/fej} 44131 C4

273 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iArtd Allah puts forward (another) example of two men, one of them dumb, who has no power over anything, and he is a burden on his master; whichever way he directs him, he brings no good. Is such a man equal to one who commands justice?} (16:76). Also, Allah said, £ 4 XL £ « p ji ii £2 fi S^} 4p^x> iHe sets forth for you a parable from your own selves : Do you have partners among those whom your right hands possess (i.e. your servants) to share as equals in the wealth we have bestowed on you?} (30:28). Mujahid commented on Allah's statement, iVerily, Allah is not ashamed to set forth a parable even of a mosquito or so much more when it is bigger than it.} "The believers believe in these parables, whether they involve large matters or small, because they

know that they are the truth from their Lord, and Allah guides the believers by these parables. In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, Ibn Mas’ud and other people among the Companions said, } By it He misleads many}, “Meaning the hypocrites. Allah guides the believers with these parables, and the straying of the hypocrites increases when they reject the parables that Allah mentioned for them which they know are true. This is how Allah misleads them.”²¹ 4‘i-t iAtid He guides thereby} meaning, with the parables, S^} irnany} from among the people of faith and conviction. Allah I 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :93. 121 At-Tabari 1 :408.

adds guidance to their guidance, and faith to their faith, because they firmly believe in what they know to be true, that is, the parables that Allah has mentioned. This is guidance that Allah grants them; 4 -jjif j —j4 4And He misleads thereby only the Fasiqin (the rebellious, disobedient to Allah)}, meaning, the hypocrites. The Arabs say that the date has Fasaqat, when it comes out of its skin, and they call the mouse a Fuwaysiqah, because it leaves its den to cause mischief. The Two Sahihs recorded 'A'ishah saying that the Messenger of Allah said, SjUilj J>Jl j> jiiUl “Five animals are Fawasiq, and they must be killed during Ihram and otherwise: the crow, the kite, the scorpion, the mouse and the rabid dog .»li Fasiq, includes the disbeliever and the disobedient. However, the Fisq of the disbeliever is worse, and this is the type of Fasiq that the Ayah is describing here, because Allah described them as, / \ 'J*' / \ t X' < > t m t S * > £ * ' \ j' ***• U ojJOsAj .Aa,1. .4 jl«u j* aUi jJl f> fw;^jf £ JLiit ^Vf 4 iThose who break Allah’s covenant after ratifying it, and sever

what Allah has ordered to be joined and do mischief on earth, it

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 174–203]

is they who are the losers.} These are the characteristics of the disbelievers and they contradict the qualities of the believers. Similarly, Allah said in Surat Ar-Ra’d, _>* yy xa S~“S. J aii ii' £• ‘tj y jLfl m Fath Al-Bari 6 :408 and Muslim 2 :856

175Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iShall he then, who knows that what has been revealed unto you (O Muhammad sg) from your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men of understanding that pay heed. Those who fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the Mithdq (bond, treaty, covenant). And those who join that which Alldh has commanded to be joined (i.e. they are good to their relatives and do not sever the bond of kinship), and fear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} (13:19-21)^ until, . ' > A \ tC' 'A ^ l' t 't ^ o' La ^jyOUij Aaj j* aA\ J-fC- ft) ilif ft. j£i\ iAnd those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Alldh has commanded to be joined (i.e. they sever the bond of kinship and are not good to their relatives), and work mischief in the land, on them is the curse (i.e. they will be far away from Allah's mercy), and for them is the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).} (13:25) The covenant that these deviant people broke is Allah’s covenant with His creation, that is, to obey Him and avoid the sins that He prohibited. This covenant was reiterated in Allah’s Books and by the words of His Messengers. Ignoring this covenant constitutes breaking it. It was said that the Ayah (2:27) is about the disbelievers and the hypocrites among the People of the Book. In this case, the covenant that they broke is the pledge that Allah took from them in the Tawrah to follow Muhammad jg when he is sent as a Prophet, and to believe in him, and in what he was sent with. Breaking Allah’s covenant in this case occurred when the People of the Book rejected the

Prophet after they knew the truth about him, and they hid this truth from people, even though they swore to Allah that they would do otherwise. Allah informed us that they threw the covenant behind their backs and sold it for a miserable price. It was also reported that the Ayah (2:27) refers to all disbelievers, idol worshippers and hypocrites. Allah took their pledge to believe in His Oneness, showing them the signs that testify to His Lordship. He also took a covenant from them to obey His commands and refrain from His prohibitions,

176 Tafsir Ibn Kathir knowing that His Messengers would bring proofs and miracles that none among the creation could ever produce. These miracles testified to the truth of Allah's Messengers. The covenant was broken when the disbelievers denied what was proven to them to be authentic and rejected Allah's Prophets and Books, although they knew that they were the truth. This Tafsir was reported from Muqatil bin Hayyan, and it is very good. It is also the view that Az-Zamakhshari held. Allah's statement next, *And sever what Allah has ordered to be joined* is in reference to keeping the relations with the relatives, as Qatadah asserted. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, *Would you then, if you were given the authority, do mischief in the land, and sever your ties of kinship?* (47:22) Ibn Jarir At-Tabari preferred this opinion. However, it has been said that the meaning of the Ayah (2:27) here is more general. Hence, everything that Allah has commanded to nurture, and the people severed, is included in its meaning.

The Meaning of 'Loss' Muqatil bin Hayyan commented on Allah's statement, *it is they who are the losers* "In the Hereafter."¹²¹ Similarly, Allah said, *On them is the curse (i.e. they will be far away from Allah's mercy), and for them is the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell)* (13:25). Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Every characteristic that Allah describes those other than the people of Islam - such as being losers - then it refers to disbelief. m At-Tabari 1 :416. 12* Ibn Abi Hatim 1:101

177 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (25 -49) (Part-1) However, when they are attributed to the people of Islam, then these terms refer to sin." Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement, *it is they who are the losers,* "Losers is plural for loser, this word refers to whoever decreased his own share of Allah's mercy by disobeying Him, just as the merchant loses in his trade by sustaining capital loss. Such is the case with the hypocrite and the disbeliever who lose their share of the mercy that Allah has in store for His servants on the Day of Resurrection. And that is when the disbeliever and the hypocrite most desperately need Allah's mercy. "2 / > JxS) i] TA 428. Hmv can you disbelieve in Allah seeing that you were dead and He gave you life? Then He will give you death, then again will bring you to life (on the Day of Resurrection) and then unto Him you will return. Allah testifies to the fact that He exists and that He is the Creator and the Sustainer Who has full authority over His servants, 4How can you disbelieve in Allah?) How can anyone deny Allah's existence or worship others with Him while; 4You were dead and He gave you life) meaning, He brought them from the state of non-existence to life. Similarly, Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 1 :417. 121 Ibid.

4Were they created by nothing? Or were they themselves the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth? Nay, but they have no firm belief} (52:35-36) and, *Has there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth mentioning?* (76:1). There are many other Ayat on this subject. Ibn Jarir reported from 'Ata' that Ibn 'Abbas said that, *Seeing that*

you were dead and He gave you life} means, “You did not exist beforehand. You were nothing until Allah created you; He will bring death to you and then bring you back to life during Resurrection.” Ibn ‘Abbas then said, “This is similar to Allah’s statement; I biil i4> |jta} iThey will say : “Our Lord! You have made us to die twice and You have given us life twice.”} (40:1 1)”11 ’ }29. He it is Wlto created for you all that is on earth. Then He Istawd ila the heaven and made them seven heavens and He is the Knower ofeverything.} Evidence ofAllah’s Ability After Allah mentioned the proofs of His creating them, and what they can witness in themselves as proof of that, He mentioned another proof that they can witness, that is, the creation of the heavens and earth. Allah said, gi&p £21 Spt p Vip 4 u p 3L \$} J. 4He it is Who created for you all that is on earth . Then He Istawd ila the heaven and made them seven heavens} meaning, He turned Al-Tabari 1 :419.

179Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) towards the heaven, 4And made them^ meaning, that He made the heaven, seven heavens. Allah said, 4And made them seven heavens and He is the Knower ofeverything^ meaning, His knowledge encompasses all His creation, just as He said in another Ayah, iShould not He Who has created know?’} (67:14). The Beginning ofthe Creation This Ayah (2:29) is explained in detail in Surat As-Sajdah where Allah said; z>j iii'i wJ ,i! jj&j jUy' j yjVi ju jjji 'r* ->•£> fey ui ^ ife bls jl WjL uii jiybj a Jli oU-j J'k ^ if Gjji zLlii (Ijj U^ .d jf j uyjj ^ yld* £r-> ^ ,.f , j* 11 '.n«^ <4S«i/ (O Muhammad jg) : "Do you verily disbelieve in Him Wlto created the earth in two Days? And you set up rivals (in worship) ivith Him? That is the Lord of all that exists. He placed therein (i.e. the earth) firm mountainsfrom above it, and He blessed it, and measured therein its sustenance (for its dwellers) in four Days equal (i.e. all these four ‘days’ were equal in the length of time) for all those who ask (about its creation). Then He Istawd ild the heaven when it ivas smoke, and said to it and to the earth : "Come both ofyou willingly or unwillingly." They both said: “We come willingly.” Then He finished them (as) seven heavens in two Days and He made in each heaven its affair. And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps (stars) to be an adornment as well as to guard (from the devils by using them as missiles against the devils). Such is the decree of the Almighty, the Knower (41:9-12).

180 Tafsir lbn Kathir These Ayat indicate that Allah started creation by creating earth, then He made heaven into seven heavens. This is how building usually starts, with the lower floors first and then the top floors, as the scholars of Tafsir reiterated, as we will come to know, Allah willing. Allah also said, *3 3Cif; Tv ,1^ . §r)\ £ UU> Ail ^ ,n UIU iiU’j jai iAre you more difficult to create or is the heaven that He constructed? He raised its height, and has perfected it. Its night He covers with darkness and its forenoon He brings out (with light). And the earth, after that, He spread it out. And brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture. And the mountains He has fixedfirmly. (To be) a provision and benefitfor you and your cattle} (79:27-33). It is said that “Then” in the Ayah (2:29) relates only to the order of reciting the information being given, it does not relate to the order that the events being mentioned took place, this was reported from lbn ‘Abbas by ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah. The Earth was created before Heaven Mujahid commented on Allah’s statement, Jfj'il 4 U p. jjfo '£} 4He it is Who createdfor you all that is on earth “Allah created the earth before heaven, and when He created the earth, smoke burst out of it. This is why Allah said, 4 <jt-> (£) fIA 2Sj?-*' ^} iThen He Istawa ild (turned towards) the heaven when it was smoke.} (41:11) jj- iAnd made them seven heavens} means, one above the other, while the ‘seven earths’ means, one below the other.”*21 At-Tabari 1 :437. 121 At-Tabari 1 :436.

181 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1 This Ayah testifies to the fact that the earth was created before heaven, as Allah has indicated in the Ayat in Surat As- Sajdah. Spreading the Earth out after the Heavens were created Sahih Al-Bukhari records that when Ibn 'Abbas was questioned about this matter, he said that the earth was created before heaven, and the earth was spread out only after the creation of the heaven. **1 Several Tafsir scholars of old and recent times also said similarly, as we have elaborated on in the Tafsir of Surat An-Nazi'at (chapter 79). The result of that discussion is that the word Daha (translated above as "spread") is mentioned and explained in Allah's statement, *And the earth, after that. He spread it out. And brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture. And the mountains He has fixed firmly.*) (79:30-32) Therefore, Daha means that the earth's treasures were brought to its surface after finishing the job of creating Fath Al-Bari 8:417.

whatever will reside on earth and heaven. When the earth became Doha, the water burst out to its surface and the various types, colors, shapes and kinds of plants grew. The stars started rotating along with the planets that rotate around them. And Allah knows best. *And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Verily, I am going to place (mankind) generations after generations on earth." They said: "Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood, — while we glorify You with praises and sanctify You." He (Allah) said: "I know that which you do not know."}* Adam and His Children inhabited the Earth, Generation after Generation Allah reiterated His favor on the Children of Adam when He stated that He mentioned them in the highest of heights before He created them. Allah said, *And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels.} This Ayah means, "O Muhammad mention to your people what Allah said to the angels, Verily, I am going to place a Khalifah on earth}. Meaning people reproducing generation after generation, century after century, just as Allah said, And it is He Who has made you (Khalifah) generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth} (6:165), And makes you (Khalifah) inheritors of the earth} (27:62),*

Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) *And if it were Our will, We would have (destroyed you (mankind all, and) made angels to replace you (Yakhlufun) on the earth} (43:60) and, after them succeeded an (evil) generation (Khalifah)} (7:169). It appears that Allah was not referring to Adam specifically as Khalifah, otherwise he would not have allowed the angels' statement, You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood}. The angels meant that this type of creature usually commits the atrocities they mentioned. The angels knew of this fact, according to their understanding of human nature, for Allah stated that He would create man from clay. Or, the angels understood this fact from the word Khalifah, which also means the person who judges disputes that occur between people, forbidding them from injustice and sin, as Al-Qurtubi said. The statement the angels uttered was not a form of disputing with Allah's, nor out of envy for the Children of Adam, as some mistakenly thought. Allah has described them as those who do not precede Him in speaking, meaning that they do not ask Allah anything without His permission. When Allah informed them that He was going to create a creation on the earth, and they had knowledge that this creation would commit mischief on it, as Qatadah mentioned, they said, Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood? This is only a question for the sake of learning about the*

wisdom of that, as if they said, Our Lord! What is the wisdom of creating such creatures since they will cause trouble in the earth and spill blood? ^ “If the wisdom behind this action is m At-Tabari 1 :464.

that You be worshipped, we praise and glorify You (meaning we pray to You) we never indulge in mischief, so why create other creatures?” Allah said to the angels in answer to their inquiry, 41 know that which you do not know> meaning, “I know that the benefit of creating this type of creature outweighs the harm that you mentioned, that which you have no knowledge of. I will create among them Prophets and send Messengers. I will also create among them truthful, martyrs, righteous believers, worshippers, the modest, the pious, the scholars who implement their knowledge, humble people and those who love Allah and follow His Messengers.” The Sahih recorded that when the angels ascend to Allah with the records of the servant’s deeds, Allah asks them, while having better knowledge, “How did you leave My servants?” They will say, “We came to them while they were praying and left them while they were praying.” ’ This is because the angels work in shifts with mankind, and they change shifts during the Fajr and ‘Asr prayers. The angels who descended will remain with us, while the angels who have remained with us ascend with our deeds. The Messenger of Allah jfe said, •jyj’#&1 «77ie deeds of the night are elevated to Allah before the morning, and the deeds of the morning before the night falls . »'2’ Hence, the angels’ statement, “We came to them while they were praying and left them while they were praying,” explains Allah’s statement, 4i>J& Y U 41 know that which you do not ktiozo It was said that the meaning of Allah’s statement, 4ZJ& Y U m Fath Al-Bari 13:426. ’ Muslim no. 179, MusnadAbi ’Awanah 1 :145.

Stira/i 2 . Al-Baaarah (25 - 49) (Part-1 185 41 knoio that which you do not know.} is, “I have a specific wisdom in creating them, which you do not have knowledge of.” It was also said that it is in answer to, IjA)} iWhile we glorify You with praises and thanks and sanctify You after which Allah said, 41 knoio that which you do not knoio}. Meaning, “I know that Iblis is not as you are, although he is among you.” Others said, ,j-Jju > r "4Will You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood, - while we glorify you ivith praises and thanks and sanctify You.} is their request that they should be allowed to inhabit the earth, instead of the Children of Adam. So Allah said to them, 41 know that which you do not know} if your inhabiting the heavens is better, or worse for you.” Ar-Razi as well as others said this. Allah knows best. The Obligation of appointing a Khalifah and some related Issues Al-Qurtubi, as well as other scholars, said that this Ayah (2:30) proves the obligation of appointing a Khalifah to pass judgements on matters of dispute between people, to aid the oppressed against the oppressor, to implement the Islamic penal code and to forbid evil. There are many other tasks that can only be fulfilled by appointing the Imam, and what is necessary in performing an obligation, is an obligation itself. We should state here that Imamah occurs by either naming a successor, as a group among Ahl As-Sunnah scholars said occurred - by the Prophet ^ - in the case of Abu Bakr, or hinting to a successor. Or, the current Khalifah names a certain person as Khalifah after him, as Abu Bakr did with ‘Umar. Or, the Khalifah might leave the matter in the hands of

432. And He taught Adam all the names (of everything), then He showed them to the angels and said, "Tell Me the names of these ifyou are truthful."} 432. They (angels) said: "Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily, You are the Knower, the Wise."} 433. He said: "O Adam! Inform them of their names," and when he had informed them of their names. He said : "Did I

not tell you that I know the Ghayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing?"} The Virtue of Adam over the Angels Allah stated the virtue of Adam above the angels, because He taught Adam, rather than them, the names of everything. This occurred after they prostrated to him. This discussion precedes that event here, only to show the importance of his position, and the absence of the angels' knowledge about creating the Khalifah when they asked about it. So Allah informed the angels that He knows what they do not know, and then He mentioned this to show them Adam's superiority over them in knowledge. Allah said, 4'+£' p; } iAnd He taught Adam all the names (of everything)}. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah; 4^ •t'V' pi (fej} iAnd He taught Adam all the names (of everything)} "Meaning, the names that people use, such as human, animal, sky, earth, land, sea, horse, donkey, and so forth, including the names of the other species." Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn m At-Tabari 1 :458

189 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) all mankind, Allah created you with His Own Hand, ordered the angels to prostrate for you and taught you the names of everything. Will you not intercede for us with your Lord, so that he relieve us from this gathering place?' On that Adam will reply, 7 cannot do what you have asked'. He will have remembered his error and will be embarrassed, saying, 'Go to Nuh, for he is the first of Allah's Messengers whom Allah sent to the people of the earth.' They will go to Nuh and ask him. He will say, 7 cannot do what you have asked.' He will recall asking Allah what he was not to know, and will also be embarrassed. He will say, 'Go to Khalil Ar-Rahman.' They will go to Ibrahim and he will also say, 7 cannot do what you have asked.' He will say, 'Go to Musa, a servant to whom Allah spoke directly and gave the Tawrdh.' Musa will say, 7 cannot do what you have asked.' He zoill remember that he killed a person without justification and will be embarrassed before his Lord. He will say, 'Go to Tsa, Allah's servant and Messenger and His Word and a spirit of His.' They will go to 'Isa and he will say, 7 will not do what you asked. Go to Muhammad, a servant whose previous and latter errors were forgiven.' They will come to me, and I will go to Allah and seek His permission and He will give me His permission. When I gaze at my Lord, I will prostrate myself and Allah will allow me to remain like that as much as He will. Then I will be addressed, 'O Muhammad! Raise your head; ask, for you will be given what you ask, and intercede, for your intercession will be accepted.' I will raise my head and thank and praise Allah with such praise as He will inspire me. I will intercede and He will grant me a quantity of people that He will admit into Paradise. I will go back to Hitn, and when I see my Lord, I will intercede and He will allow me a quantity that He will admit into Paradise. I will do that for a third and then a fourth time. I will say, 'There are no more people left in Hell except those whom the Qur'an has incarcerated and have thus acquired eternity in Hell This Hadxth was collected by Muslim, An- I 1 * Allah's Word and spirit; the meaning here is that Allah created him with a word, "Be" and he was, and that he is a spirit from the spirits that Allah created, as Ibn Kathlr discusses later. Fath Al-Bari 8:10. 12]

Nasa'i ' and Ibn Majah.

The reason why we mentioned this Hadith here is the Prophet's statement, - >r " ol l)jjLi n J5 sUif «They will go to Adam and say, 'O Adam! You are the father of all mankind, and Allah created you with His Own Hand, ordered the angels to prostrate for you, and taught you the names of everything'*}2} This part of the Hadith testifies to the fact that Allah taught Adam the names of all creatures. This is

why Allah said, \$ 'ffff' {} iThen He showed them to the angels} meaning, the objects or creations. 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said, "Allah paraded the objects before the angels. Sy* i&\ Lif}} }And said, "Tell Me the names of these if you are truthful".'*3] Allah's statement means, "Tell Me the names of what I paraded before you, O angels who said, 4WUI You place therein those who will make mischief therein and shed blood}. You asked, 'Are You appointing a Khalifah from us or from other creations? We praise and glorify You. Therefore, Allah said, "If you say the truth, that if I appoint a non-angel Khalifah on the earth, he and his offspring will disobey Me, commit mischief and shed blood, but if I designate you the Khalifahs you will obey Me, follow My command and l1 ' Muslim 1 : 181 , and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :284. ^ Muslim 1:181, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6:364, and Ibn Majah 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :42

191Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) honor and glorify Me. However, since you do not know the names of the objects I paraded before you, then you have even less knowledge of what will occur on the earth that does not exist yet." 4 SJ &\ tide ^ u 4They (angels) said: "Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily, it is You, the Ktiower, the Wise."}. Here the angels are praising Allah's holiness, and perfection above every kind of deficiency, affirming that no creature could ever acquire any part of Allah's knowledge, except by His permission, nor could anyone know anything except what Allah teaches them. This is why they said, 4:<^\ cS\ ^ u "}" 4"Glory is to You, we have no knowledge except what you have taught us. Verily You are the Knower, the Wise^ meaning, Allah is knowledgeable of everything, Most Wise about His creation, and He makes the wisest decisions, and He teaches and deprives whom He wills from knowledge. Verily, Allah's wisdom and justice in all matters is perfect. Adam's Virtue of Knowledge is demonstrated Allah said, F* <i\ i» J» v p fit* J 4(fi>c)Jj& C (Xetj ojiV'j 4He said: "O Adam! Inform them of their names," and when he had informed them of their names, He said : "Did I not tell you that I know the Ghayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and l knmv what you reveal and what you have been concealing?"} Zayd bin Aslam said, "You are Jibril, you are Mika'il, you are Israfil, until he mentioned the name of the crow."111 Mujahid said that Allah's statement, m Ibn Abi Hatim 1:118.

4rr\$ r\ (4'^ 4He said: "O Adam! Inform them of their names,"} "The name of the pigeon, the crow and everything."^ Statements of a similar meaning were reported from Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, and Qatadah ' When Adam's virtue over the angels became apparent, as he mentioned the names that Allah taught him, Allah said to the angels, £j <~±- xs\ 4Did I not tell you that / know the Chayb (unseen) in the heavens and the earth, and I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing?} This means, "Did I not state that I know the seen and unseen matters." Similarly, Allah said, yf oij^ iAnd if you (O Muhammad jg) speak (the invocation) aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and tint which is yet more hidden^ (20:7). Also, Allah said about the hoopoe, that it said to Sulayman; HAs Shaytan (Satan) has barred them from Allah's way] so they do not prostrate before Allah, Wlw brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth, and knows what you conceal and what you reveal. Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be worshipped but He), the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} (27:25-26). They also have comments other than what we have said about the meaning of Allah's statement, 4SJ& pr c; 4And I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing}. ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1:119. <2 ' Ibid.

It is reported from Ad-Dahhak that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, 4And I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing^ means, “I know the secrets, just as I know the apparent things, such as, what Iblis concealed in his heart of arrogance and pride.” Abu Ja’far Ar-Razi narrated that Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas said that, 4oJS4p ojij l* jXetj^ 4And I know what you reveal and what you have been concealing} means, “The apparent part of what they said was: ‘Do you create in it that which would commit mischief and shed blood?’ The hidden meaning was: “We have more knowledge and honor than any creation our Lord would create.’ But they came to know that Allah favored Adam above them regarding knowledge and honor.” 4 ri , St Gjfw (3% 1 bii >Ij} 434. And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam." And they prostrated except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused and was proud and was one of the disbelievers (disobedient to Allah).} Honoring Adam when the Angels prostrated before Him This Ayah mentions the great honor that Allah granted Adam, and Allah reminded Adam's offspring of this fact. Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, as this Ayah and many Hadiths testify, such as the Hadith about the intercession that we discussed. There is a Hadith about the supplication of Musa, “O my Lord! Show me Adam who caused us and himself to be thrown out of Paradise.” When Musa met Adam, he said to him, “Are you Adam whom Allah created with His Own Hands, blew life into and commanded the angels to prostrate before?”² 111 At-Jabari 1 :498. Abu DSwud 5:28.

194 Tafsir Ibtal Kathir Iblis was among Those ordered to prostrate before Adam, although He was not an Angel When Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, Iblis was included in this command. Although Iblis was not an angel, he was trying - and pretending - to imitate the angels' behavior and deeds, and this is why he was also included in the command to the angels to prostrate before Adam. Satan was criticized for defying that command, as we will explain with detail, Allah willing, when we mention the Tafsir of Allah's statement, & J-4<1 4Except Iblis (Satan). He was one of the Jinn; he disobeyed the command of his Lord> (18:50) Similarly, Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Before he undertook the path of sin, Iblis was with the angels and was called ‘Azazil.’ He was among the residents of the earth and was one of the most active worshippers and knowledgeable persons among the angels. This fact caused him to be arrogant. Iblis was from a genus called Jinn.” The Prostration was before Adam but the Obedience was to Allah Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, Gii iAnd (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam .")> “The obedience was for Allah and the prostration was before Adam. Allah honored Adam and commanded the angels to prostrate before him.”²¹ Some people said that this prostration was just a prostration of greeting, peace and honor, hence Allah's statement, Cji (ri'j V-K jlij iir*~J it JJ 1,1 At-Tabari 1 :502. At-Tabari 1 :512.

295 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iAtid he (Prophet Yusuf) raised his parents to the throne and they fell down before him prostrate. And he said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My Lord has made it come true!"} (12 :100) The practice of prostrating was allowed for previous nations, but was repealed for ours. Mu'adh said to the Prophet jg, “I visited Ash-Sham and found that they used to prostrate before their priests and scholars. You, O Messenger of Allah, are more deserving of prostration.” The Prophet said, Uj- .jj JL>wJ j! SI j*N ^JLj j jl \fo ±1 -JJ *No. If I was to command any human to prostrate before another human, I would command the wife to prostrate before her husband because of the enormity of his right on her.»^{lii} Ar-Razi agreed with this view. Also,

Qatadah said about Allah's statement, *cn 0*8 j&lJj J SAf\ Yy i* And they prostrated except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused and was proud and zvas one of the disbelievers (disobedient to Allah).} "Iblis, the enemy of Allah, envied Adam because Allah honored Adam. He said, "I was created from fire, and he was created from clay.' Therefore, the first error ever committed was arrogance, for the enemy of Allah was too arrogant to prostrate before Adam."121 I - Ibn Kathlr - say, the following is recorded in the Sahih, In in JuL jsJ b\ s ji Jji-Ju «No person who has the weight of a mustard seed of arrogance in his heart shall enter Paradise .» |31 Iblis had disbelief, arrogance, and rebellion, all of which caused him to be expelled from the holy presence of Allah, and His mercy. 111 At-Tirmidhi no. 1 109, Majma'Az-Zawa'id 4 :310. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :123. 131 Muslim 1 :93

4Verily, You are the Knozoer, the Wise .} Then Adam fell asleep, as the People of the Book and other scholars such as Ibn 'Abbas have stated, Allah took one of Adam's left ribs and made flesh grow in its place, while Adam was asleep and unaware. Allah then created Adam's wife, Hawwa', from his rib and made her a woman, so that she could be a comfort for him. When Adam woke up and saw Hawwa' next to him, it was claimed, he said, 'My flesh and blood, my wife.' Hence, Adam reclined with Hawwa'. When Allah married Adam to Hawwa' and gave him comfort, Allah said to him directly. tjS .jcl&% isg i£# & it psfr 4"0 Adam! Dwell you and your wife in the Paradise and eat both of you freely with pleasure and delight, of things therein wherever you will, but come not near this tree or you both will be of the Zdlimin (wrongdoers)."}.^ Allah testsAdam Allah's statement to Adam, 4 *ji cpi 4but come not near this tree} is a test for Adam. There are conflicting opinions over the nature of the tree mentioned here. Some said that it was the grape tree, barley, date tree, fig tree, and so forth. Some said that it was a certain tree, and whoever eats from it will be relieved of the call of nature. It was also said that it was a tree from which the angels eat so that they live for eternity. Imam Abu JaTar bin Jarir said, "The correct opinion is that Allah forbade Adam and his wife from eating from a certain tree in Paradise, but they ate from it. We do not know which tree that was, because Allah has not mentioned anything in the Qur'an or the authentic Sunnah about the nature of this tree. It was m At-Tabari 1 :514.

said that it was barley, grape, or a fig tree. It is possible that it was one of those trees. Yet, this is knowledge that does not bring any benefit, just as being ignorant in its nature does no harm. Allah knows best." ' This is similar to what Ar-Razi stated in his Tafsir, and this is the correct opinion. Allah's statement, iThen the Shaytan made them slip therefrom} either refers to Paradise, and in this case, it means that Shaytan led Adam and Hawwa' away from it, as 'Asim bin Abi An-Najtid recited it.' ' It is also possible that this Ayah refers to the forbidden tree. In this case, the Ayah would mean, as Al-Hasan and Qatadah stated, "He tripped them."3 ' In this case, iThen the Shaytan made them slip therefrom} means, "Because of the tree", just as Allah said, iTitmed aside therefrom (i.e. from Muhammad jg and the Qur'an) is he who is turned aside (by the decree and preordainment ofAllah)} (51:9) meaning, the deviant person becomes turned aside - or slips - from the truth because of so and so reason. This is why then Allah said, tif li. \Z^(.j3&} 4And got thetn outfrom that in which they were} meaning, the clothes, spacious dwelling and comfortable sustenance. 111 At-Tabari 1 :520. •2| Ibn Abiyatim 1:128. •3| Ibn Abi HStim 1 :128, 129.

199Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) 4Wc said: "Get you down, all, with enmity between yourselves. On earth will be a dwelling place for you and an enjoymentfor a time."} meaning, dwelling,

sustenance and limited life, until the commencement of the Day of Resurrection Adam was very Tall Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ubayy bin Ka*b said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, jii ilb Ills Jv) i Jii ^i> yJrj fST jU a Xjj Sjj* lib 'b U Jti vllJ AiP Jaii lib^ Jj. ft U :^;pl llSVii oii-li <Ujl ^ »A//o/j created Adam tall, with thick hair, just as a date tree with full branches. When Adam ate from the forbidden tree, his cover fell off, and the first thing that appeared was his private area. When he saw his private area, he ran away in Paradise and his hair got caught in a tree. He tried to free himself and Ar-Rahmdn called him, O Adam! Are you running away from Me?' When Adam heard the words of Ar-Rahmdn (Allah), he said, 'No, O my Lord! But I am s/iy.'s Adam remained in Paradise for an Hour Al-Hakim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Adam was allowed to reside in Paradise during the time period between the 'Asr (Afternoon) prayer, until sunset." Al-Hakim then commented this is "Sahih according to the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim), but they did not include it in their collections. Also, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded Ibn 'Abbas saying, "Allah sent Adam to earth to an area called, Dahna, between Makkah and At-Ta'if." Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that Adam was sent down to India, while Hawwa' was sent to Jeddah. Iblls was sent down to Dustumaysan, several miles from Basra. Further, the Ibn Abi Hatim 1:129. ,2i Al-Hakim 2 :542 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:131.

snake was sent down to Asbahan. This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim J ' Also, Muslim and An-Nasa'i recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, "Friday is the best day on which the sun has risen. On Friday, Allah created Adam, admitted him into Paradise, and expelled him from it V21 A Doubt and a Rebuttal If one asks, "If the Paradise that Adam was thrown out of was in heaven, as the majority of the scholars assert, then is it possible for Iblls to enter Paradise, although he was expelled from it by Allah's decision (when he refused to prostrate before Adam)?" Basically, the response to this would be that the Paradise which Adam was in, was in the heavens, not on the earth, as we explained in the beginning of our book Al-Bidayah wan- Nihayah. The majority of scholars said that Shaytan was originally prohibited from entering Paradise, but there were times when he sneaked into it in secret. For instance, the Tawrah stated that Iblls hid inside the snake's mouth and entered Paradise. Some scholars said that it is possible that Shaytan led Adam and Hawwa' astray on his way out of Paradise. Some scholars said that he led Adam and Hawwa' astray when he was on earth, while they were still in heaven, as stated by Az- Zamakhshari. Al-Qurtubi mentioned several beneficial Hadiths here about snakes and the ruling on killing them. <37. Then Adam received from his Lord Words. And his Lord pardoned him (accepted his repentance). Verily, He is the One Who forgives (accepts repentance), the Most Merciful.> 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :132. Muslim 2 :585, and An-Nasa'i 3 :90.

Adam repents and supplicates to Allah It was reported that the above Ayah is explained by Allah's statement, S; J G j jfc Cxi 437. They said: "Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers") (7:23) as Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-RabT bin Anas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Khalid bin Ma'dan, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam have stated . As-Suddi said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on, iy# Vi 4 Then Adam received from his Lord Words) "Adam said, 'O Lord! Did You not create me with Your Own Hands?' He said, 'Yes.' He said, 'And blow life into me?' He said, 'Yes.' He said, 'And when I sneezed, You said, 'May Allah grant you His mercy.' Does not Your mercy precede Your anger?' He was told, 'Yes.' Adam said, 'And You destined me to commit this evil act?' He was told, "Yes.' He said, If I repent, will You send me back to Paradise?' Allah said,

‘Yes.’”[21 Similar is reported from Al-‘Awfi, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Mahad, and Ibn ‘Abbas . Al-Hakim recorded this Hadith in his Mustadrak from Ibn Jubayr, who narrated it from Ibn ‘Abbas. Al-Hakim said, "Its chain is Sahih and they (Al- Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it." Allah’s statement, * & 4 Verily, He is the One Who forgives (accepts repentance), the Most Merciful) (2:37) means that Allah forgives whoever regrets his error and Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :136 and At-Tabari 1 :543, 546. At-Tabari 1 :543 : 131 At-Tabari 1 :542

J mm v ' ' * > - 1 ~ - ' mm \j p-j^- lS'j^a C-^1^ 1 Xsrk 'Ljy~*~*j CP-\S >j3 i_yjS2^lj <SZ^ lllli ^ dyuS^S| j}UiL4 rn^!d.l^fe*jt» ajL^IU ^^.'Ij-. ^.* -j Af > ^*>/»/i i *^i-* ,. Tafefr Ibn Kathir K returns to Him in repentance. This meaning is similar to Allah’s statements, £z ^ ii 3 tpj:& 4 ‘nQ %’P iAnd whoever does evil or wrongs himselfo (4:110) and sSj jzfr iAnd whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds» (25:71). The Ayat mentioned above, testify to the fact that Allah forgives the sins of whoever repents, demonstrating His kindness and mercy towards His creation and servants. There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah, the Most Forgiving, the Most Merciful. (U 'fj ftic. i_i>- & iJI'Ia iSXk^ pdb\j lili iLfr (£. LJS^ i tA~,oj4li t^i jii 4-^A t*UJl tiiG [flsj, \fj& lj "fg.ityjZ iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants (9:104), (4lL jl itjX jlZ i38. We said: "Get down all of you from this place (the Paradise), then whenever there comes to you Hudan (guidance) from Me, and whoever follows My guidance, there shall be no fear on than, nor shall they grieve.> 439. But those who disbelieve and belie Our Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) - such are the dwellers of the Fire. They shall abide therein forever."^

203Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Allah stated that when He sent Adam, Hawwa’, and Shaytan to earth from Paradise, He warned them that He will reveal Books and send Prophets and Messengers to them, i.e., to their offspring. Abu Al-‘Aliyah said, UAI-Huda, refers to the Prophets, Messengers, the clear signs and plain explanation.” iAnd whoever follows My guidance^ meaning, whoever accepts

what is contained in My Books and what I send the Messengers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 203–209]

with, iThere shall be nofear on them regarding the Hereafter, j*at inor shall they grieve} regarding the life of this world. Similarly, in Surat Ta Ha, Allah said, * iuigP ciii£ ty% jflpZ CJr L££ jli> / , '• v> " •" * / . "TP aLLa 4He (Allah) said: “Get you down (from the Paradise to the earth), both ofyou, together, some ofyou are an enemy to some others. Then if there comes to you guidance from Me, then whoever follows My guidance, he shall neither go astray, nor shall he be distressed.} (20:123) Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “He will not be misguided in this life or miserable in the Hereafter. ”^21 The Ayah, >> t 'S. i iBut whosoever turns away from My Reminder (i.e. neither believes in this Qur'an nor acts on its teachings) verily, for him is a life of hardship, and We shall raise him up blind on the Day of Resurrection .} (20:124) is similar to what Allah stated here, ^ 'tV' cl.rl - slyjj'j^ 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 139. 121 AMabari 18:389.

204 Tafsrr Ibn Katlur iBnt those who disbelieve and belie Our Aydt - such are the dwellers of the Fire. They shall abide therein forever}, meaning, they will remain in Hell for eternity and will not find away out of it. (jf>\S jjl Xi£* ijkjtj >15*1 ^4 \jprii \$40 4ft ijB % 4 \$ i'jjfe ^ ti tiiai ^ i^iij 4#^^ 440. O Children

of Israel! Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you, and fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you) so that I fulfill (My obligations to) your covenant (with Me), and fear none but Me.} 442. And believe in what I have sent down (this Qur'an), confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injil), and be not the first to disbelieve therein, and buy not with My verses (the Tawrah and the Injil) a small price (i.e. getting a small gain by selling My verses), and fear Me and Me alone.} Encouraging the Children of Israel to embrace Islam Allah commanded the Children of Israel to embrace Islam and to follow Muhammad jg. He also reminded them with the example of their father Israel, Allah's Prophet Ya'qub, as if saying, "O children of the pious, righteous servant of Allah who obeyed Allah! Be like your father, following the truth." This statement is similar to one's saying, "O you son of that generous man! Do this or that" or, "O son of the brave man, engage the strong fighters," or "O son of the scholar, seek the knowledge," and so forth. Similarly, Allah said. 40 offspring of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Niih (Noah)! Verily, he was a grateful servant} (17:3). Israel is Prophet Ya'qub (Jacob) Israel is Prophet Ya'qab, for Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that 'Abdullah Ibn 'Abbas said, "A group of Jews came to the Prophet and he said to them,

205 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) "Do you know that Israel is Jacob?*" They said, "Yes, by Allah." He said, «O Allah! Be zoifness.»" |1! At-Tabari recorded that 'Abdullah Ibn 'Abbas said that Israel' means, "the servant of Allah."121 Allah's Blessings for the Children of Israel Allah said, 4Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you}. Mujahid commented, "Allah's favor that He granted the Jews is that He made water gush from stones, sent down manna and quails for them, and saved them from being enslaved by Pharaoh."*31 Abu Al-'Aliyah also said, "Allah's favor mentioned here is His sending Prophets and Messengers among them, and revealing Books to them."*4 * I - Ibn Kathir - say that this Ayah is similar to what Musa said to the Children of Israel, 40 my people! Remember the favor of Allah to you : when He made Prophets among you, made you kings, and gave you what He had not given to any other among the nations (of their time} (5:20) meaning, during their time. Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you,} means, "My support for you and your fathers," that is saving them from Pharaoh and his people. Musnad At-Tayalisi no . 356 At-Tabari 1 :553. 131 At-Tabari 1 :556 Ibid.

206 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Reminding the Children of Israel of Allah's Covenant with Them Allah's statement, iAnd fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you) so that I fulfill (My obligations to) your covenant (with Me),} means, 'My covenant that I took from you concerning Prophet Muhammad sfe, when he is sent to you, so that I grant you what I promised you if you believe in him and follow him. I will then remove the chains and restrictions that were placed around your necks, because of the errors that you committed.'111 Also, Al-Hasan Al-Basri|21 said, "The 'covenant' is in reference to Allah's statement, j) iit Jtljj J^c. jLJi. b_Lo_) Sie&l ij-bt : 'm -v ***>•<" i sis. t tv ^ tjo 4jipVt^^ tip indeed, Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel (Jews), and We appointed twelve leaders among them. And Allah said: "I am with you if you perform As-Salath and give Zakath and believe in My Messengers; honor and assist them, and lend a good loan to Allah, verily, I will expiate your sins and admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise)} (5:12)." Other scholars said, "The covenant is what Allah took from them in the Tawrah, in that. He will send a great Prophet - meaning Muhammad aS - from among the offspring of Ismail, who will be obeyed by all peoples. Therefore, whoever obeys him, then Allah will forgive his sins, enter him into Paradise and award him two

rewards.”We should mention here that Ar- Razi mentioned several cases of information brought by the earlier Prophets regarding the coming of Muhammad Further, Abu Al-‘Aliyah said that, m At-Jabari 1 : 555& 557. At-Jabari 1 :109.

207Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) 4And fulfill (your obligations to) My covenant (with you)} means, “His covenant with His servants is to embrace Islam and to adhere to it.” Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, ‘I fulfill My obligations to you’ means, 1 (Allah) will be pleased with you and admit you into Paradise. ”121 As-Suddi, Ad- Dahhak, Abu Al-‘Aliyah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said similarly. Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement, 4AndfearMe and Me alone.} means, “Fear the torment that I might exert on you, just as I did with your fathers, like the mutation, etc.”!31 This Ayah contains encouragement, followed by warning. Allah first called the Children of Israel, using encouragement, then He warned them, so that they might return to the Truth, follow the Messenger jg, heed the Qur’an’s prohibitions and commands and believe in its content. Surely, Allah guides whom He wills to the straight path. Allah said next, 4And believe in what I have sent down, confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injil)} meaning, the Qur’an that Allah sent down to Muhammad ag, the unlettered Arab Prophet, as bringer of glad tidings, a wamer and a light. The Qur’an contains the Truth from Allah and affirms what was revealed beforehand in the Tawrah and the Injil (the Gospel). Abu Al-‘Aliyah said that Allah’s statement, 4And believe in what I have sent down (this Qur'an), confirming that which is with you (the Tawrah and the Injil)} “means, ‘O People of the Book! Believe in what I sent down that conforms to what you have.’ This is because they find the description of Muhammad jg recorded in the Tawrah and the At-Jabari 1 :558. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :143. !3 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :144.

2M Tafstr Ibn Kathir Injll.” Similar statements were attributed to Mujahid, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas and Qatadah. Allah said, 4-a j/fc Jj* "jj} 4and be not the first to disbelieve therein}. Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “Do not become the first to disbelieve in the Qur’an (or Muhammad jg), while you have more knowledge in it than other people.”121 Abu Al-‘Aliyah commented, “Do not become the first to disbelieve in Muhammad,’ meaning from among the People of the Book, ‘after you hear that he was sent as a Prophet.’”3 * Similar statements were attributed to Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas.*4 * Ibn Jarir stated that the Ayah (disbelieve therein 2:41) refers to the Qur’an, mentioned earlier in the Ayah, iin what 1 have sent down (this Qur'an),} Both statements are correct because they are inter-related. For instance, whoever disbelieves in the Qur’an will have disbelieved in Muhammad sis, and whoever disbelieves in Muhammad will have disbelieved in the Qur’an. Allah’s statement, ft Jjfa 4thefirst to disbelieve therein} means, do not become the first among the Children of Israel to disbelieve in it, for there were people from Quraysh and the Arabs in general who rejected Muhammad sfe before the People of the Book disbelieved in him. We should state here that the Ayah is talking about the Children of Israel in specific, because the Jews in Al-Madlnah were the first among the Children of Israel to be addressed by the Qur’an. Hence, their disbelief in the Qur’an means that they were the first among the People of the Book to disbelieve in it. *** Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :145. 121 Ibid. Ibid. 141 Ibid.

209Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Allah’s statement, 04 O' iand buy not with My verses a small price,} means, “Do not substitute faith in My Ayat and belief in My Prophet with the life of this world and its lusts which are minute and bound to end.” Allah said, iand have Taqwa ofMe and Me alone}.

Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Talq bin Habib said, “Taqwa is to work in Allah’s obedience, on a light from Allah, hoping in Allah’s mercy, and to avoid Allah’s disobedience, on a light from Allah, fearing Allah’s punishment.” 11 Allah’s statement, O Pi (fj} iandfearMe andMe alone} means, that Allah warns the People of the Book against intentionally hiding the truth and spreading the opposite of it, as well as, against defying the Messenger jg. ijyi iyiv> iji-jVj yj} 442. And mix not truth with falsehood, nor conceal the truth while you know (the truth).} i43. And perform As-Saldlt, and give Zakdh, and bozo down along with Ar-Raki'in .}

The Prohibition of hiding the Truth and distorting It

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 209–249]

with Falsehood Allah forbade the Jews from intentionally distorting the truth with falsehood and from hiding the truth and spreading falsehood, iAnd mix not truth with falsehood, nor conceal the truth while 111 Ibid. 1 :147.

you know (the truth)). So Allah forbade them from two things; He ordered them to make the truth known, as well as explaining it. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas mentioned the Ayah, i0t J&' IjjE iAtid mix not truth with falsehood} and said; “Do not mix the truth with falsehood and the facts with lies.” Qatadah said that, <-3**j * 'j }Atid mix not truth with falsehood} means, “Do not mix Judaism and Christianity with Islam, iwhile you know (the truth).} that the religion of Allah is Islam, and that Judaism and Christianity are innovations that did not come from Allah.”¹²¹ It was reported that Al-Hasan Al-Basri said similarly.¹³¹ Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, inor conceal the truth while you know (the truth).} means, “Do not hide the knowledge that you have of My Messengerandwhathe was sent with. His description, whichyou know about, canbe found written in the Books thatyou have.”¹⁴¹ It is possible that it means, “..although you know the tremendous harm that this evil will cause people, misguiding them and leading them to the Fire, because they will follow the falsehood that you mixed with the truth in your claims.” jyfcj *jW’)ji*~Aj} iAnd perform As-Salat and give Zakah, and bow down along with Ar-Rdki'in.} At-Tabari 1 :569. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :147. 131 Ibid. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:148.

Slira!i 2. Al-Bnqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) 211 Muqatil said, “Allah’s statement to the People of the Book, iAtid perform As-Saldhy commands them to perform the prayer behind the Prophet sg, iand give Zakdh commands them to pay the Zakah to the Prophet and iand bcnv dozen along zoith Ar-Raki'fn commands them to bow down with those who bow down among the Ummah of Muhammad jfe. Allah therefore commands the People of the Book to be with, and among the Ummah of Muhammad In addition, Allah’s statement, iAnd bow dozen along with Ar-Raki'in) means, “And be among the believers performing the best deeds they perform, such as, and foremost, the prayer.” Many scholars said that this Ayah (2:43) is proof for the obligation of performing the prayer in congregation (for men only). I will explain this ruling in detail in Kitab Al-Ahkam Al-Kabir, Allah willing. v^SJ' ojiii jjC J-U)' ojyQ^ i44. Enjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves, while you recite the Scripture (TawraJt))! Have you then no sense? The Condemnation of commanding Others to observe Righteousness while ignoring Righteousness Allah said, “How is it, O People of the Book, that you command people to perform Al-Birr, which

encompasses all types of righteousness, yet forget yourselves and do not heed what you call others to? And you read Allah's Book (the m Al-Kashaf 1 :133.

Tawrah) and know what it promises to those who do not fulfill Allah's commandments. iHave you then no sense?} of what you are doing to yourselves, so that you might become aware of your slumber and restore your sight from blindness?" 'Abdur-Razzdq said that Ma'mar stated that Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, iEnjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves,} "The Children of Israel used to command people to obey Allah, fear Him and perform Al-Birr. Yet, they contradicted these orders, so Allah reminded them of this fact." ' As-Suddi said similarly. Ibn Jurayj said that the Ayah iEnjoin you Al-Birr on the people "Is about the People of the Book and the hypocrites. They used to command people to pray and fast. However, they did not practice what they commanded others. Allah reminded them of this behavior. So whoever commands people to do righteousness, let him be among the first of them to implement that command."121 Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said that, j} 4And you forget yourselves,} means, "You forget to practice it yourselves, iWhile you recite the Scripture (Tawrah)! Have you then no sense?} You forbid the people from rejecting the prophethood and the 111 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :44. 121 At-Tabari 2 :8

covenant that you have mentioned with you in the Tawrah, while you yourselves have forgotten it, meaning that 'you have forgotten the covenant that I made with you that you will accept My Messenger. You have breeched My covenant, and rejected what you know is in My Book.' "*" 11 Therefore, Allah admonished the Jews for this behavior and alerted them to the wrongs that they were perpetrating against themselves by ordering righteousness, yet refraining themselves from righteousness. We should state that Allah is not criticizing the People of the Book for ordering righteousness, because enjoining good is a part of righteousness and is an obligation for the scholars. However, the scholar is himself required to heed, and adhere to, what he invites others to. For instance, Prophet Shu'ayb said, Cj i&J c -W it Z j; 3 '4 %} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you. I only desire reform to the best of my power. And my guidance cannot come except from Allah, in Him I trust and unto Him I repent} (11:88). Therefore, enjoining righteousness and performing righteousness are both required. Neither category is rendered not necessary by the practice of the other, according to the most correct view of the scholars among the Salaf (predecessors) and the Khalaf.'21 Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Wa'il said, "While I was riding behind Usamah, he was asked, 'Why not advise 'Uthman?' He said, *Do you think that if I advise him I should allow you to hear it? I advise him in secret, and I will not start something that I would hate to be the first to start. I will not say to a man, *You are the best man,' even if he was my leader, after what I heard from the Messenger of Allah j&.' They said, "What did he say?" He said, T heard him say, A-list (jixis jlill t, »L>u> 111 At-Tabari 2:7. ^ The scholars who came after the first three generations of Islam

U j0l ~ ".I 11 jL*>«Jl jjJj A-jT 'Jj L_jjytliL C-iS : J>4J ,jP "A man will be brought on the Day of Resurrection and thrown in the Fire. His intestines will fall out and he will continue circling pulling them behind him, just as the donkey goes around the pole. The people of the Fire will go to that man and ask him, 'What happened to you? Did you not used to command us to do righteous acts and forbid us from committing evil?' He will say, 'Yes. I used to enjoin righteousness, but refrained from

performing righteousness, and I used to forbid you to perform from evil while I myself did it. This Hadith was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Also, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i said, "I hesitate in advising people because of three Ayat. A'f^ Jf. AEnjoin you Al-Birr on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves}. "2 C ijij J liL. jf==> ijlofjui *5/ & p. AO you who believe! Why do you say that which you do not do? Most hateful it is to Allah that you say that which you do not do} (61:2-3).
 **21 And Allah informed us that the Prophet Shu'ayb said, yyj Cj ci-' C. ii* U dj jXild J Jyl A^S ^ AI wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you. I only desire reform to the best of my power. And my guidance cannot come except from Allah, in Him I trust and unto Him I repent} (11:88).
 111 Fath Al-Bari 6 :381 and Muslim 4 :2291 , Ahmad 5 :205. 121 Al-Qurtubi 1:367.

^ Art prli <45. And seek help in patience and As-Saldu (the prayer) and truly, it is extremely heavy and hard except for Al-Khush'i'in .} <46 (They are those) who are certain that they are going to meet their Lord, and that unto Him they are going to return .} The Support that comes with Patience and Prayer Allah commanded His servants to use patience and prayer to acquire the good of this life and the Hereafter. Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah means, "Utilize patience and the obligatory prayer in seeking the Hereafter. As for patience (here), they say that it means fasting."111 There are similar texts reported from Mujahid. Al-Qurtubi and other scholars commented, "This is why Ramadan is called the month of patience,"121 as is mentioned in the Hadith literature. It was also said that 'patience' in the Ayah means, refraining from evil, and this is why 'patience' was mentioned along with practicing acts of worship, especially and foremost, the prayer. Also, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that 'Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "There are two types of patience: good patience when the disaster strikes, and a better patience while avoiding the prohibitions of Allah." Ibn Abi Hatim said that Al-Hasan Al-Basri was reported to have said similarly.131 Allah then said, iAnd As-Saldu (the prayer).} The prayer is one of the best means of assistance for firmly adhering to Allah's orders, just as Allah said; £2 ykiJi JET\ j) Z
 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :154. Al-Qurtubi 1 :372 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :155.

iRecite (O Muhammad jgj what has been revealed to you of the Book (the Qur'an), and perform As-Saldu. Verily, As-Saldu (the prayer) prevents from Al-Fahshd' (i.e. great sins of every kind), and Al-Munkar and the remembrance of (praising) of (you by) Allah is greater indeed£ (29:45). The personal pronoun in the Ayah, 4'1P 4And truly, it is extremely heavy and hard^ refers to prayer, as Mujahid is reported to have said, and it was also the choice of Ibn Jarir. It is possible that the pronoun might be referring to the advice - to observe patience and the prayer - mentioned in the same Ayah. Similarly, Allah said about Qarun (Korah), Vj jj J*. Jif L>\y pji iBut those who had been given (religious) knowledge said: "Woe to you! The reward of Allah (in the Hereafter) is better for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and this, none shall attain except As-Sabirun (the patient)."> (28:80). Also, Allah said, /CK ij'Jc ifjJ' Ijji J is jS Sy-'i jp. vi \ % iThe good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal. Repel (the evil) with one which is better than verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it (the above quality) except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion (of happiness in the Hereafter and) in this world. (41:34-35) meaning, this advice is only implemented by those who are patient and the fortunate. In any case, Allah's statement here means, prayer is heavy and burdensome', iexcept for Al-Khashi'in .\$.>

217 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, "They (Al-Khashi'in) are those who believe in what Allah has revealed." ^1 ' Allah's statement, iThey are those who are certain that they are going to meet their Lord, and that unto Him they are going to return . continues the subject that was started in the previous Ayah. Therefore, the prayer, or the advice to observe it is heavy, 4except for Al-Khashi'in. (They are those) xoho are certain (Yazunnuna) that they are going to meet their Lord,} meaning, they know that they will be gathered and face their Lord on the Day of Resurrection, *4\ iand that unto Him they are going to return .} meaning, their affairs are all subject to His will and He justly decides what He wills. Since they are certain that they will be returned to Allah and be reckoned, it is easy for them to perform the acts of obedience and refrain from the prohibitions. Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement; 4Yazunnuna that they are going to meet their Lord} Ibn Jarir said; "The Arabs call certainty as well as doubt, Zann. There are similar instances in the Arabic language where a subject as well as its opposite share the same name. For instance, Allah said, i&sQy jL)' \1jf} iAnd the Mujrimiin (criminals, polytheists, sinners), shall see the Fire and Zannu (apprehend) that they have to fall therein}^18:53). It is recorded in the Sahih that on the Day of Resurrection, IM At-Tabari 2:16.

218 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah will say to a servant, "Have I not allowed you to marry, honored you, made the horses and camels subservient to you and allowed you to become a chief and a master?" He will say, "Yes." Allah will say, "Did you have Zann (think) that you will meet Me?" He will say, "No." Allah will say, "This Day, I will forget you, just as you forgot Me." ^ If Allah wills, we will further elaborate on this subject when we explain Allah's statement, ijiiey haveforgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them (9:67). 447. O Children of Israel! Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you and that I preferred you over the 'Alamin (nations)} Reminding the Children of Israel that They were preferred above the Other Nations Allah reminds the Children of Israel of the favors that He granted their fathers and grandfathers, how He showed preference to them by sending them Messengers from among them and revealing Books to them, more so than any of the other previous nations. Similarly, Allah said, 4And We chose them (the Children of Israel) over the 'Alamin, (nations) with knowledge.} (44:32) and, fdl 'Ei 3%. i; r - JU» k&'j* J v* J'jy i.K'j&X && p b p&j 4And (remember) when Miisd (Moses) said to his people: "O my people! Retnember thefavor ofAllah to you : when He made Prophets among you, made you kings, honored you above the 'Alamin (nations)."} (5:20). Abu JaYar Ar-Razi reported that Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said that 111 Muslim 4:2279.

219 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) Abu Al-'Aliyah said that Allah's statement, iand that I preferred you over the 'Alamin> means, "The kingship, Messengers and Books that were granted to them, instead of granting such to the other kingdoms that existed during their time, for every period there is a nation.)1 ' It was also reported that Mujahid, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, Qatadah and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said similarly. 121 The Ummah of Muhammad jg is Better than the Children of Israel This is the only way the Ayah can be understood, because this Ummah is better than theirs, as Allah said; j£ j3 &xl jjj 4You are the best of people ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin good and forbid evil, and you believe in Allah. And had the People of the Book (Jews and Christians) believed, it would have been betterfar them> (3:1 10). Also, the Musnad and Sunan Collections of Hadith recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al-Qushayri said that the Messenger of Allah said, •pi Ji- lfrjVj U'Jfa -J\ "Vow (Muslims) are the seventieth nation, but you are the best and most honored ofthem according to Allah. »|3 There

are many Hadiths on this subject, and they will be mentioned when we discuss Allah's statement, *pi£ £> iYou are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind (3:110). p% 3s ft \$ tiii ft& ij i ft At-Tabari 2 :24 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:158. Ahmad 5 :3 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :352 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1433*

448. And fear a Day (of Judgement) when a person shall not avail another, nor will intercession be accepted from him, nor will compensation be taken from him, nor will they be helped.} After Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the favors that He has granted them, He warned them about the duration of the torment which He will punish them with on the Day of Resurrection. He said, y. \$Andfear a Day} meaning, the Day of Resurrection, iWhen a person shall not avail another} meaning, on that Day, no person shall be of any help to another. Similarly, Allah said, iAnd no bearer of burdens shall bear another's burden} (35:18) & W*. rri iEvery man that Day will have enough to make him careless of others.} (80:37) and. o* & is pS £8 J-ti 40 mankind! Have Taqwd of your Lord (by keeping your duty to Him and avoiding all evil), and fear a Day when no father can avail aught for his son, nor a son avail aught for his father} (31:33). This indeed should serve as a great warning that both the father and the son will not be of help to each other on that Day. Neither Intercession, Ransom, or Assistance will be accepted on behalf of the Disbelievers Allah said,

221 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) in or will intercession be accepted from him} meaning, from the disbelievers. Similarly, Allah said, 4So no intercession of intercessors will be of any use to them} (74:48) and described the people of the Fire saying, £^4#« 0 &} iNow we have no intercessors. Nor a close friend (to help us)} (26:100-101). Allah's statement here (2:48) ite^Q y,} in or will compensation be taken from him} means, that Allah does not accept the disbelievers to ransom themselves. Similarly, Allah said, t\$ i Vg <\$ l{ } <4 iVerily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them even if they offered it as a ransom (3:91) Ji *4i b >*.» . /iS-iJ ijgjR j. d J \fjzj==> cyji iVerily, those who disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again therewith to ransom themselves from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it would never be accepted of them, and theirs would be a painful torment> (5:36) iQi ii-jj V ijic jkas> j_)2 ^ff} iAnd even if he offers every ransom, it will not be accepted from him} (6:70) and, iSo this Day no ransom shall be taken from you (hypocrites), nor of those who disbelieved. Your abode is the Fire. That is your Mawla (friend - proper place)} (57:15).

Allah stated that if the people do not believe in His Messenger jg and follow what He sent him with, then when they meet Him on the Day of Resurrection, after remaining on the path of disbelief, their family lineage and/or the intercession of their masters will not help them at all. It will not be accepted of them, even if they paid the earth's fill of gold as ransom. Similarly, Allah said, \ * »**-* ij-? * a*T 4Before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, twr intercession} (2:254) and, 40n which there will be neither mutual bargaining nor befriending (19:31). Allah's statement next, in or will they be helped.} means, "no person shall get angry - or anxious - on their behalf and offer them any help, or try to save them from Allah's punishment." As stated earlier on that Day, neither the relative, nor persons of authority will feel pity for the disbelievers, nor will any ransom be accepted for them. Consequently, they will receive no help from others and they will be helpless themselves. Allah said, 4<S vj %} iWhile He (Allah) grants refuge (or protection), but none grants refuge from Him} (23:88) 4So on that Day none will punish as He will punish. And none will bind (the wicked, disbelievers and

polytheists) as He will bind} (89:25-26) jrT fj? > if- 4"What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another (as you used to do in the world)?" Nay, but that Day they shall surrender} (37:25-26) and,

223Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (25 - 49) (Part-1) iThen why did those whom they had taken far dliyah (gods) besides Al- lah, as a way of ap- proach (to Allah) not help them? Nay, but they vanished completely from them> (46:28). Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that Allah's statement, v j3 4"What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another?"} (37:25) means, "This Day, you shall not have a refuge from Us. Not this Day." 1 11 Ibn Jarir said that Allah's statement, a inuigii V, ^hj;-fe5 piuj4^2 p-4=Llj1 Cgty 3^ ilj *', Zt " " 'C\ 'A t •> |i *. - ^JKfa >£^pS£L«Jp {jp JfciiI I^ssCXp(s.ill»J flp ^ Ojilkapj - flit iTyJLbUj \$&jj inor will they be helped.) meaning, on that Day, they shall neither be helped by any helper, nor shall anyone intercede on their behalf. No repeal or ransom will be accepted for them, all courtesy towards them will have ceased, along with any helpful intercession. No type of help or cooperation will be available for them on that Day. The judgment will, on that Day, be up to the Most Great, the Most Just, against whom no intercessor or helper can ever assist. He will then award the evil deed its kind and will multiply the good deeds. This is similar to Allah's statement, IM At-Tabari 2 :36

iBut stop them, verily, they arc to be questioned. "What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another?" Nay, but that Day they shall surrender (37:24-26).111 i>yC> J'i >,j *• pi?* pCl'i Jj 449. And (remember) when We delivered you from Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people, who were afflicting you with a horrible torment, killing your sons and sparing your women, and therein was a mighty trialfrom your Lord 450. And (remember) when We separated the sea for you and saved you and drowned Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people while you were watching. The Children ofIsraelwere saved from Pharaoh and His ArmyWho drowned Allah said to the Children of Israel, "Remember My favor on you 4"3«*£if *>* ffcyjr-i J' 4And (remember) when We delivered you from Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people, who were afflicting you with a horrible torment,\$ meaning, 'I - Allah - saved you from them and delivered you from their hands in the company of Musa, after they subjected you to horrible torture.' This favor came after the cursed Pharaoh had a dream in which he saw a fire emerge from Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), and then the fire entered the houses of the Coptics in Egypt, with the exception of the Children of Israel. Its purport was that his kingship would be toppled by a man among the Children of Israel. It was also said that some of Pharaoh's entourage said that the Children of Israel were expecting a man among them to arise who would establish a state for them. We will mention the Hadith on this subject |i| At-Tabari 2 :35

225Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) when we explain Surat Ta Ha (20), Allah willing. After the dream, Pharaoh ordered that every newborn male among the Children of Israel be killed and that the girls be left alone. He also commanded that the Children of Israel be given tasks of hard labor and assigned the most humiliating jobs. The torment here refers to killing the male infants. In Surat Ibrahim (14) this meaning is clearly mentioned, jppj ppAP> iWho were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were slaughtering your sons and letting your women live.} (14:6). We will explain this Ayah in the beginning of Surat Al-Qasas (28), Allah willing, and our reliance and trust are with Him.

The meaning of, iP-Ap*t* iwho toere afflicting you} is, “They humiliated you,” as Abu ‘Ubaydah stated. It was also said that it means, “They used to exaggerate in tormenting you” according to Al-Qurtubi. As for Allah saying, 4cpP iAP*P*U spi;} i killing your sons and sparing your women} that explains His statement, 4y'Ju!' yppA*P*i iwho were afflicting you with horrible torment} then it explains the meaning of the favor He gave them, as mentioned in His statement, i£p pA\p jAn iRemember My favor which I bestowed upon you}. As for what Allah said in Surat Ibrahim, iP pA. pAP'vi iAnd remind them of the annals of Allah} (14:5) meaning, the favors and blessing He granted them, He then said, iWho were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were

226 Tafstr Ibn Kathir slaughtering your sons and letting your women live.} (14:6) So Allah mentioned saving their children from being slaughtered in order to remind them of the many favors that He granted them. We should state here that ‘Pharaoh’ (Fir'awn) is a title that was given to every disbelieving king who ruled Egypt, whether from the ‘Amallq (Canaanites) or otherwise, just as Caesar (Qaysar) is the title of the disbelieving kings who ruled Rome and Damascus. Also, Khosrau (Kisra) is the title of the kings who ruled Persia, while Tubb'a is the title of the kings of Yemen, and the kings of Abyssinia (Ethiopia) were called Negus (An-Najashi). Allah said, \$\$ j. fa jj} iAnd therein was a mighty trial from your Lord.} Ibn Jarir commented that this part of the Ayah means, “Our saving your fathers from the torment that they suffered by the hand of Pharaoh, is a great blessing from your Lord.”! * We should mention that in the blessing there is a test, the same as with hardship, for Allah said, iAnd We shall make a trial of you with evil and with good} (21:35) and, fit9^5 iAnd We tried them with good (blessings) and evil (calamities) in order that they might turn (to obey Allah.)) (7:168). Allah's statement next, iAnd (remember) when We separated the sea for you and saved you and drowned Fir'awn's (Pharaoh) people while you were watching} means, ‘After We saved you from Fir'awn and you escaped with Musa; Fir'awn went out in your pursuit and We parted (il At-Tabari 2 :48

227 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) the sea for you.’ Allah mentioned this story in detail, as we will come to know, Allah willing. One of the shortest references to this story is Allah's statement, 4And saved you} meaning, “We saved you from them, drowning them while you watched, bringing relief to your hearts and humiliation to your enemy.” Fasting the Day of Ashura It was reported that the day the Children of Israel were saved from Fir'awn was called the day of ‘Ashura’. Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah came to Al-Madlnah and found that the Jews were fasting the day of ‘Ashura’. He asked them, “What is this day that you fast?” They said, “This is a good day during which Allah saved the Children of Israel from their enemy, and Musa used to fast this day.” The Messenger of Allah sfe said, «J have more right to Musa than you luive.o So the Messenger of Allah jfe fasted that day and ordered that it be fasted. This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah. [1) t < f f* •"j ' / * /w ^ s • ^ aIJ 3T OJ filial uiij'i -W Cjt 451. And (remember) when We appointed for Miisd (Moses) forty nights, and (in his absence) you took the calf (for ivorship), and you were Zalimun (polytheists and wrongdoers) .> 452. Then after that We forgave you so that you wight be grateful.} 453. And (remember) ivhen We gave Musa tire Scripture (the Tawrdlt)) and the criterion (of right and wrong) so that you Ahmad 1 :291 , Fath Al-Bari 4 :287, Muslim 2 :796, An-Nasa'i in At- Kubrd 2 :157, and Ibn Majah 1 :553.

228 Tafstr Ibn Kathir may be guided aright.} The Children of Israel worshipped the Calf Allah then said, "Remember My favor on you when I forgave you for worshipping the calf." This happened after Musa went to the meeting place with his Lord at the end of that period which was forty days. These forty days were mentioned in Surat Al-A'raf when Allah said, iAnd We appointed for Musa thirty nights and added (to the period) ten (more)} (7:142). It was said that these days were during the month of Dhul- Qa'dah plus the first ten days in Dhul-Hijjah, after the Children of Israel were delivered from Fir'awn and they safely crossed the sea. Allah's statement, iss Lyi iAnd (remember) when We gave Musa the Scripture} means, the Tawrah, iXM} iAnd the criterion} that is that which differentiates between truth and falsehood, guidance and deviation. fa} iSo that you may be guided aright}, after escaping the sea, as another Ayah in Surat Al-A'raf clearly stated, 14 ^ S' iAnd indeed We gave Musa - after We Imd destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture (the Tawrah) as an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember (or receive admonition)} (28:43). dl IjSji* j*»)' ffi&A syi -**_>£) >\f} ji ft (Mfa tfS 454. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my

229 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1 people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf. So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves (the innocent kill the wrongdoers among you), that will be better for you with your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance. Truly, He is the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful. } The Children of Israel kill each other in Repentance This was the repentance required from the Children of Israel for worshipping the calf. Commenting on Allah's statement; iAnd (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf...}, Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, "When their hearts thought of worshipping the calf, AAii \Hj-j p ijlS ijii Ji Ijljj Jai- iAnd when they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they (repented and) said : "If our Lord does not have mercy upon us and forgive us"} (7:149). This is when Musa said to them. pm pi iO my people! Verily, you have wronged yourselves by worshipping the calf...}' Abu 'Al-'Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas commented on. iSo turn in repentance to your Bari'} that it means, "To your Creator."121 Allah's statement, ito your Bari' (Creator)} alerts the Children of Israel to the enormity of their error and means, "Repent to He Who created you after you associated others with Him in worship." An-Nasa'i, Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded Ibn 'Abbas t 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :167. Ibn Abi Hatim 1:167,168.

saying, "Allah told the Children of Israel that their repentance would be to slay by the sword every person they meet, be he father or son. They should not care whom they kill. Those were guilty whom Musa and Harun were not aware of their guilt, they admitted their sin and did as they were ordered. So Allah forgave both the killer and the one killed." * This is part of the HaCLith about the trials that we will mention in Surat Ta Ha, (20) Allah willing. Ibn Jarir narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Musa said to his people, k4-#} ji ft £yC i*p£ pi -p2u\ ijSS 4" So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill each other (the innocent kill the wrongdoers among you), that will be better for you with your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance. Truly, He is the One Wlw accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.} Allah ordered Musa to command his people to kill each other. He ordered those who worshipped the calf to sit down and those who did not worship the calf to stand holding knives in their hands. When they started killing them, a great darkness suddenly overcame them. After the darkness lifted, they had killed seventy thousand of them. Those who were killed among them were forgiven, and those who remained alive were also forgiven."*2 And (remember) when you said: "O Musa! We shall never believe in you

until we see Allah plainly.” But you were seized with a bolt of lightning while you were looking}. Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful.} 111 An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :404 , At-Tabari 18 :306, and Ibn Abi Hatim At-Tabari 2:73.

231 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) The Best among the Children of Israel ask to see Allah; their subsequent Death and Resurrection Allah said, ‘Remember My favor on you for resurrecting you after you were seized with lightning when you asked to see Me directly, which neither you nor anyone else can bear or attain.’ This was said by Ibn Jurayj. Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah iAnd (remember) when you said: "O Miisa ! We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly/> means, “Publicly”, 111 “So that we gaze at Allah.”¹²¹ Also, Tirmidhi bin Ruwaym said that Allah’s statement, iWhile you were looking means, “Some of them were struck with lightning while others were watching.”¹³¹ Allah resurrected those, and struck the others with lightning. As-Suddi commented on, iBut you were seized with a bolt of lightning saying; “They died, and Musa stood up crying and supplicating to Allah, ‘O Lord! What should I say to the Children of Israel when I go back to them after You destroyed the best of them, it is ill for me and my people. If it had been Your will, You could have destroyed them and me before; would You destroy us for the deeds of the foolish ones among us?’ Allah revealed to Musa that these seventy men were among those who worshipped the calf. Afterwards, Allah brought them back to life one man at a time, while the rest of them were watching how Allah was bringing them back to life. That is why Allah’s said, iThen We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful.} At-Tabari 2 :81 ¹²¹ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :170. ¹³¹ Ibn Abi Hatim 1:172.

gratefully W Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas said, “Death was their punishment, and they were resurrected after they died so they could finish out their lives.” Qatadah said similarly.[^] ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on this Ayah, “Musa returned from meeting with his Lord carrying the Tablets on which He wrote the Tawrah. He found that they had worshipped the calf in his absence. Consequently, he commanded them to kill themselves, and they complied, and Allah forgave them. He said to them, These Tablets have Allah’s Book, containing what He commanded you and what He forbade for you.’ They said, ‘Should we believe this statement because you said it? By Allah, we will not believe until we see Allah in the open, until He shows us Himself and says: This is My Book, therefore, adhere to it. Why does He not talk to us as He talked to you, O, Musa?’” Then he (‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd) recited Allah’s statement, JS&& iWe shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly> and said, “So Allah’s wrath fell upon them, a thunderbolt struck them, and they all died. Then Allah brought them back to life after He killed them.” Then he (‘Abdur-Rahman) recited Allah’s statement, iThen We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful}, and said, “Musa said to them, Take the Book of Allah.’ They said, ‘No.’ He said, “What is the matter with you?’ They said, The problem is that we died and came back to life.’ He said, Take the Book of Allah.’ They said, ‘No.’ So Allah sent some angels who made the mountain topple over them.”¹³¹ This shows that the Children of Israel were required to fulfill the commandments after they were brought back to life. However, Al-Mawardi said that there are two opinions about this matter. The first opinion is that since the Children of Israel were required to fulfill the commandments after they were brought back to life, so they did not have to fulfill the commandments. The second opinion states that they were required to adhere to the commandments, so

that no responsible adult is free of such responsibilities. Al-Qurtubi said that this is what is correct, because, he said, although the Children of Israel witnessed these tremendous calamities and incidents, that did not mean that they were not responsible for fulfilling the commandments any more. Rather they are responsible for that, and this is clear. Allah knows best. (i u oi [fX* cSjtill) cP! Uj [di\ V?&*3 i57. And We shaded you with clouds and sent down on you Al-Manna and the quail, (saying): "Eat of the good lawful things We have provided for you," (but they rebelled). And they did not wrong Us but they wronged themselves. The Shade, the Manna and the Quail After Allah mentioned the calamities that He saved the Children of Israel from, He mentioned the favors that He granted them, saying, iAnd We shaded you with clouds}. This Ayah mentions the white clouds that provided shade for the Children of Israel, protecting them from the sun's heat during their years of wandering. In the Hadith about the trials, An-Nasa'i recorded Ibn 'Abbas saying, "Allah shaded the Children of Israel with clouds during the years of wandering." Ibn Abi Hatim said, "Narrations similar to that of Ibn 'Abbas were reported from Ibn Tjmar, Ar- Rabl* bin Anas, Abu Mijlaz, Ad-Dahhak, and As-Suddi."121 Al- Hasan and Qatadah said that, iAnd We shaded you with clouds} "This happened when they were in the desert and the clouds shielded them from the An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :405 Ibn Abi Ratim 1 :174.

sun."1 11 Ibn Jarir said that several scholars said that the type of cloud the Ayah mentioned, "was cooler and better than the type we know."121 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, iAnd sent down on you Al-Manna>, "The manna used to descend to them to the trees, and they used to eat whatever they wished of it." Also, Qatadah said, "The manna, which was whiter than milk and sweeter than honey, used to rain down on the Children of Israel, just as the snow falls, from dawn until sunrise. One of them would collect enough for that particular day, for if it remained more than that, it would spoil. On the sixth day, Friday, one would collect enough for the sixth and the seventh day, which was the Sabbath during which one would not leave home to seek his livelihood, or for anything else. All this occurred in the wilderness."131 The type of manna that we know provides sufficient food when eaten alone, because it is nutritious and sweet. When manna is mixed with water, it becomes a sweet drink. It also changes composition when mixed with other types of food. However, this is not the only type. The evidence to this fact is that Al-Bukhari narrated, that Said bin Zayd said that the Messenger of Allah^ said, ^3 -P It fcsto uKam'ah (truffles) is a type of manna, and its liquid is a remedy for the eyes ."141 This Hadith was also collected by Imam Ahmad. 151 The group of Hadith compilers, with the exception of Abu Dawud, also collected it, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Hasan SahihJ61 At- Tirmidhi recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that the Messenger of Ibn Abi Hatim 1:174, At-Tabari 2:91. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:176. 141 Path Al-Bari 8:14. 151 Ahmad 1:187. 161 Fath Al-Bari 8:14, Muslim 3:1619, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:235, An- Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 4 : 370 , and Ibn Majaih 2 : 1 143

235 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) Allah jg said, ,j* j*^Jl ^ja »Li t\$jj &>Jl lj* o^AJUIt "The 'Ajwah (pressed, dried date) is from Paradise and it cures poison, Al-Kam'ah (truffles) is a fort of manna, and its liquid heals the eye."* At-Tirmidhi is the only one of them who recorded this Hadith)^ As for the quail (Saliva) in question, 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The [Saliva) is a bird that looks like the quail. "2 * This is the same opinion reported from Mujahid, Ash-Sha'bi, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, 'Ikrimah and Ar- RabT bin Anas, may Allah have mercy upon them.*3 * Also, 'Ikrimah said that the Salwa is a bird in Paradise about the size of a sparrow.*41 Qatadah said "The

Salwa is a bird that is similar to a sparrow. During that time, an Israelite could catch as many quails as was sufficient for that particular day, otherwise the meat would spoil. On the sixth day, Friday, he would collect what is enough for the sixth and the seventh day, the Sabbath, during which one was not allowed to depart his home to seek anything.”*5 Allah said, !y, iEat of the good lawful things We have provided for you,} (7:160) this form of command is a simple order of allowance, guiding to what is good. Allah said, p 4 -'«i^ *-?^*^ c\$ j iAnd they did not wrong Us but they wronged themselves} means, *We commanded them to eat from what We gave them, and to perform the acts of worship (but they rebelled).’ This Ayah is similar to Allah’s statement, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi6 :233 & 235 ' At-Tabari 2 :96 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :178. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :179. Ibid.

4Eat of the provision of your Lord, and be grateful to Him (34 :15). Yet, the Children of Israel rebelled, disbelieved and committed injustice against themselves, even though they saw the clear signs, tremendous miracles and extraordinary events.

The Virtue of Muhammad's Companions over the Companions of all Other Prophets Here it is important to point out the virtue of Muhammad’s Companions over the companions of the other Prophets. This includes firmness in the religion, patience and the lack of arrogance, may Allah be pleased with them. Although the Companions accompanied the Prophet jg in his travels and battles, such as during the battle of Tabuk, in intense heat and hardship, they did not ask for a miracle, though this was easy for the Prophet^ by Allah’s leave. And when the Companions became hungry, they merely asked the Prophet jg - to invoke Allah - for an increase in the amount of food. They collected whatever food they had and brought it to the Prophet sg, and he asked Allah to bless it, told each of them to take some food, and they filled every pot they had. Also, when they needed rain, the Prophet jg asked Allah to send down rain, and a rain cloud came. They drank, gave water to their camels and filled their water skins. When they looked around, they found that the cloud had only rained on their camp. This is the best example of those who were willing to accept Allah’s decision and follow the Messenger of Allah sg. Ijljij lijkL ijijijij Ijly j&Li Gii —sjfc ji- Jjk-j j¥• 4L. 4 iyIf VLj !i-W b*'-' 458. And (remember) when We said: "Enter this town (Jerusalem) and eat bountifully tlterein with pleasure and delight wherever you wish, and enter the gate in prostration (or bowing with humility) and say: 'Forgive us,' and We shall forgive you your sins and shall increase (reward) for the good-doers 459. But those who did wrong changed the word from Hurt which had been told to them for another, so We sent upon the wrongdoers Rijz (a punishment) from the heaven because of

237Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) their rebellion.} The Jews were Rebellious instead of Appreciative when They gained Victory Allah admonished the Jews for avoiding Jihad and not entering the holy land as they had been ordered to do when they came from Egypt with MOsa. They were also commanded to fight the disbelieving ‘Amallq (Canaanites) dwelling in the holy land at that time. But they did not want to fight, because they were weak and exhausted. Allah punished them by causing them to become lost, and to continue wandering, as Allah has stated in Surat Al-Ma'idah (5). The correct opinion about the meaning of, ‘the holy land’ mentioned here is that it was Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), as As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas, 1 Qatadah and Abu Muslim Al-Asfahani, as well as others have stated. Musa said, (Jcl J’jIT jrjj? yi. * ' ' ” r JyLLii yicrS iiiUu SU i JitoiSiL>^1{^piSsj J>T [y\£=»j ' liU’i 4l4y £ jft& Jf s^saf AVr t£3 iO people! Enter the holy land which Allah has assigned to you and

turn not back (in flight).} (5:2 1) However, some scholars said that the holy land is Jericho, Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 18 1 121 Ar-Razi 3:82.

(Ariha) and this opinion was mentioned from Ibn ‘Abbas and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd. After the years of wandering ended forty years later, in the company of Yuwsha* (Joshua) bin Nun, Allah allowed the Children of Israel to conquer the holy land on the eve of a Friday. On that day, the sun was kept from setting for a little more time, until victory was achieved. When the Children of Israel conquered the holy land, they were commanded to enter its gate while, 4prostrating^ in appreciation to Allah for making them victorious, triumphant, returning them to their land and saving them from being lost and wandering. Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, iattd enter the gate Sujjadan} means, “While bowing”. 11 ' Ibn Jarir reported Ibn ‘Abbas saying, iand enter the gate in prostration} means, “Through a small door while bowing.” Al-Hakim narrated it, and Ibn Abi Hatim added, “And they went through the door backwards!” Al-Hasan Al- Basri said that they were ordered to prostrate on their faces when they entered the city, but Ar-Razi discounted this explanation. It was also said that the Sujud mentioned here means, ‘submissiveness’, for actually entering while prostrating is not possible. Khaslf said that “Ikrimah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The door mentioned here was facing the Qiblah.” Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said that the door is the door of Hittah in Ilyla’, which is Jerusalem. Ar-Razi also reported that some of them said that it was a door in the direction of the Qiblah”. Khaslf said that ‘Ikrimah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Children of Israel entered the door sideways. As-Suddi said that Abu Said Al-Azdy said that Abu Al-Kanud said that ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud said that they were (i| At-Tabari 2:113.

239Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) commanded to, 4&Si ^qi j&%} ienter the gate in prostration (or bowing with humility)} but instead, they entered while their heads were raised in defiance. Allah said next, 4*^ lAA»^ iand say: ‘Hittah’}. Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “Seek Allah’s forgiveness.”121 Al-Hasan and Qatadah said that it means, “Say, ‘Relieve us from our errors.’”3’ iand We shall forgive you your sins and shall increase (reward) far the good-doers Here is the reward for fulfilling Allah’s commandment. This Ayah means, “If you implement what We commanded you, We will forgive your sins and multiply your good deeds.” In summai, upon achieving victory, the Children of Israel were commanded to submit to Allah in tongue and deed and, to admit to their sins and seek forgiveness for them, to be grateful to Allah for the blessings He gave them, hastening to do the deeds that Allah loves, as He said, {4***4 4 u-UJ’ iWhen there comes the help ofAllah (to you, O Muhammad jfe against your enemies) and the conquest (of Makkahj. And you see that the people enter Alldlt’s religion (Islam) in croivds. So glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Wlw accepts the repentance.} (110). Allah said, 4^i> Jj if *Ai y&} iBut those who did wrong changed the word from that which had been told to themfar another}. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :183. ' Ibid. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :185.

241Surah 2. Al-Bagaralt (50 - 74) (Part-1) Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Every word in Allah’s Book that says Rijz means, ‘a punishment.’ ”1 ' Mujahid, Abu Malik, As-Suddi, Al-Hasan and Qatadah were reported to have said that Rijz means Torment.’121 Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Sa’d bin Malik, Usamah bin Zayd and Khuzaymah bin Thabit said that the Messenger of Allah said, jLS ^r* fi . j Ojf-Uail® uThe plague is a Rijz, a punishment with which Allah punished those before yo«.» This is also how An-Nasa’i recorded this HadithJ41 In addition, the basis of this Hadith was collected in the

Two Sahihs, *If you hear of the plague in a land, then do not enter it.®151 Ibn Jarir recorded Usamah bin Zayd saying that the Messenger of Allah jg said, % *'*** ^ j!' «This calamity and sickness (i.e. the plague) is a Rijz, a punishment with which some nations who were before you were punished .»|61 The basis of this Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahihs. b_ :2 Glii iu Ctj-rtiiii biiii -ifs* j—'.I Jfjii v i >>«-3 «*' ojj Ot lA^=» «jA>' i-* - 460. And (remember) when Musa asked for water for his people, We said: "Strike the stone with your stick." Then 111 At-Tabari 2:118. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :187. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 186. An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 4 :362 151 Path Al-Bari 10 :189 , and Muslim 4 :1739 161 At-Tabari 2:1 16. 171 Fafh Al-Bari 6 :512 , Muslim 4:1737.

? Tafsfr Ibn Katlur gushed forth therefrom twelve springs. Each (group of) people knew its own place for ivater. "Eat and drink of that which Allah has provided and do not act corruptly, making mischief on the earth Twelve Springs gush forth Allah said, "Remember My favor on you when I answered the supplication of your Prophet, MQsa, when he asked Me to provide you with water. I made the water available for you, making it gush out through a stone. Twelve springs burst out of that stone, a designated spring for each of your tribes. You eat from the manna and the quails and drink from the water that I provided for you, without any effort or hardship for you. So worship the One Who did this for you. 44-*^ UiVi .) 4And do not act corruptly, making mischief on the earth) meaning, "Do not return the favor by committing acts of disobedience that cause favors to disappear." Ibn 'Abbas said that the Children of Israel, "Had a square stone that MQsa was commanded to strike with his staff and, as a result, twelve springs burst out of that stone, three on each side. Each tribe was, therefore, designated a certain spring, and they used to drink from their springs. They never had to travel from their area, they would find the same bounty in the same manner they had in the first area."111 This narration is part of the long Hadith that An-Nasa'i, Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded about the trials. This story is similar to the story in Surat Al-'Araf (Chapter 7) although the latter was revealed in Makkah. In Surat Al- A'raf, Allah used the third person when He mentioned the Children of Israel to the Prophet gg and narrated what He favored them with. In this Surat Al-Baqarah, which was revealed in Al-Madlnah, Allah directed His Speech at the Children of Israel. Further, Allah said in Surat Al-A'raf, 'j~* liiif il* ' - 'y'ti) HI At-Tabari 2:120.

243Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1 iAttd there gushed forth out of it twelve springs} (7:160), describing what first occurred when the water begins to gush out. In the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, Allah described what happened later on, meaning when the water burst out in full force. Allah knows best. G U & jf*i J ui-jL£ rii ji' JVi C+U; 461 . And (remember) when you said, "O Musa ! We camwt endure one kind offood. So invoke your Lord for us to bring forth for us ofwhat the earth grows, its herbs, its cucumber its Film, its lentils and its onions." He said, "Would you exchange that which is better for that which is loioer? Co you down to any town and you shallfind lolwt you want!"} The Children ofIsraelpreferredFoods inferior toManna and Quails Allah said, "And remember My favor on you when I sent down the manna and quails to you, a good, pure, beneficial, easily acquired food. And remember your ungratefulness for what We granted you. Remember how you asked Musa to exchange this type of food for an inferior type that consists of vegetation, and so forth." Al-Hasan Al-Basri said about the Children of Israel, "They were bored and impatient with the type of food they were provided. They also remembered the life they used to live, when their diet consisted of lentils, onions, garlic and herbs." They said, 40 Musa ! We cannot endure one kind offood. So invoke your Lordfor us to

bring forth for us of what the earth grows, its herbs, its cucumbers, its Film, its lentils and its onions}. They said, -i&Z &} 40 tie kind of food} meaning, the manna and quails, because they ate the same food day after day. The Ayah mentioned

lentils, onions and herbs, which are all known types of foods. As for the Fum, Ibn Mas'ud read it, Thum (garlic). Also, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Al-Hasan said about the Ayah, 4Its Fum}, "Ibn 'Abbas said that Fum means, garlic." He also said that the expression, 'Fumu-lanna' means, 'bake for us', according to the languages of old. Ibn Jarir commented, "If this is true, then 'Fum' is one of the words whose pronunciation were altered, the letter 'fa' was replaced by the letter 'tha', since they are similar in sound."*2 * And Allah knows best. Others said that Fum is wheat, the kind used for bread. Al-Bukhari said, "Some of them said that Fum includes all grains or seeds that are eaten." Allah's statement, 4% > 24 4He said, "Would you exchange that which is better for that which is lower?"} criticized the Jews for asking for inferior foods, although they were living an easy life, eating tasty, beneficial and pure food. Allah's statement, 4Go you down to any Misr} means, 'any city', as Ibn 'Abbas said.*3 ' Ibn Jarir also reported that Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said that the Ayah refers to Misr, the Egypt of Fir'awn.*4 * The truth is that the Ayah means any city, as Ibn 'Abbas and other scholars stated. Therefore, the meaning of Musa's statement to the Children of Israel becomes, "What you are asking for is easy, for it is available in abundance in any city that you might enter. So since what you asked for is available in all of the villages and cities, I will not ask Allah to provide us with it, especially when it is an inferior type of food." This is why Musa said to them, 4^ ErU *4 !^i ijU*% Ji 4< Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :193. ' At-Jabari 2:130. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :194 At-Jabari 2 :134

245 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) 4Would you exchange that which is better for that which is lower? Go you down to any town and you shall find what you want! > Since their request was the result of boredom and arrogance and since fulfilling it was unnecessary, their request was denied. Allah knows best. 461. And they were covered with humiliation and misery, and they drew on themselves the wrath of Allah. That was because they used to disbelieve in the Ayat (proofs, evidence) of Allah and killed the Prophets wrongfully. That was because they disobeyed and used to transgress the bounds (in their disobedience to Allah, i.e. committing crimes and sins.)) (2:61) Covering the Jews in Humiliation and Misery Allah said, 4^^::i!, iljsi > ^ iAnd they were covered with humiliation and misery). This Ayah indicates that the Children of Israel were plagued with humiliation, and that this will continue, meaning that it will never cease. They will continue to suffer humiliation at the hands of all who interact with them, along with the disgrace that they feel inwardly. Al-Hasan commented, "Allah humiliated them, and they shall have no protector. Allah put them under the feet of the Muslims, who appeared at a time when the MajQs (Zoroastrians) were taking the Jizyah (tax) from the Jews." 1 11 Also, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and As-Suddi said that 'misery' used in the Ayah means, 'poverty'. 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi said that 'misery' means, 'paying the tilth (tax). In addition, Ad-Dahhak commented on Allah's statement, Ibn Abi H&tim 1:195, 196. 121 Ibn Abi H&tim 1 :196. '3 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :196.

*1—"i J&j} iatid they drew on themselves the wrath of Allah}, "They deserved Allah's anger."111 Also, Ibn Jarir said that, 4^ i%j} iand they drew on themselves the wrath of Allah} means, "They went back with the wrath. Similarly, Allah said, iVerily, I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours} (Al-Ma'idah 5:29) meaning, 'You will end up carrying my, and your, mistakes instead of me'.

Thus, the meaning of the Ayah becomes. They went back carrying Allah's anger; Allah's wrath descended on them; they deserved Allah's anger.' "2' Allah's statement, KKA" si' / AThat was because they used to disbelieve in the Ayat (proofs, evidences, etc.) of Allah and killed the Prophets wrongfully.} means, "This is what We rewarded the Children of Israel with: humiliation and misery." Allah's anger that descended on the Children of Israel was a part of the humiliation they earned, because of their defiance of the truth, disbelief in Allah's Ayat and belittling the carriers of Allah's Law i.e. the Prophets and their following. The Children of Israel rejected the Messengers and even killed them. Surely, there is no form of disbelief worse than disbelieving in Allah's Ayat and murdering the Prophets of Allah. Meaning of Kibr Similarly, in a Hadith recorded in the Two Sahihs the Messenger of Allah jgg said, v'Kibr, is refusing the truth and degrading (belittling) people .»(3) At-Tabari 2:138 >2 ' Ibid. Muslim 1 : 93

247 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) Imam Ahmad recorded, 'Abdullah bin Mas*ud saying that the Messenger of Allah jfc said, Irt Jilij {Ujj : llJ Jii jl «The people who will receive the most torment on the Day of Resurrection are: a man who was killed by a Prophet or who killed a Prophet, an unjust ruler and one who mutilates (the dead)j [l] Allah's statement, 4 ju \y\£s*j } iThat was because they disobeyed and used to transgress the bounds> mentions another reason why the Children of Israel were punished in this manner, for they used to disobey and transgress the limits. Disobedience is to do what is prohibited, while transgression entails overstepping the set limits of what is allowed and what is prohibited. Allah knows best. (fSj M O** >>* '>* u!^' 4 til ji* 'Jj (!j& *j>>- \$\$ ^4^ 462 . Verily, those who believe and those who are Jews and Christians, and Sabians (Sabi'in), whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day and does righteous good deeds shall have their reward with their Lord, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} Faith and doing Righteous Deeds equals Salvation in all Times After Allah described the condition - and punishment - of those who defy His commands, fall into His prohibitions and transgress set limits by committing prohibited acts, He stated that the earlier nations who were righteous and obedient received the rewards for their good deeds. This shall be the case, until the Day of Judgment. Therefore, whoever follows the unlettered Messenger and Prophet shall acquire eternal happiness and shall neither fear from what will happen in the future nor become sad for what has been lost in the past. Ahmad 1 :407

J mm ' • 'j \j [] !» o'jjl6^ j\$y£\>*izx:& ijJ0 Xfr fr''^ ' J-vai Jj4» (ill'J JjO 3^iu\$ia£4 ijti0 i>Usfci i>jW*^0jj^d.AjJ.J's£^£0 \$<££Sc j^,ijl i0jf -Ji01 Tg/sfr Ibn Kathir \-, Similarly, Allah said, _S> v if ibjt 'Cl vi> £ *; 4No doubt! Verily, the Awliyd' of Allah , no fear shall come upon them nor shall they grieve\$ (10:62). The angels will proclaim to the dying believers, as mentioned, 4jii u-> yu c^jJ' 6^ J£j y&x !&* « !^2 vt i^lj f0jX^c-J> iVerily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah (alone)," and then they stand firm, on them the angels will descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised!}". (41:30) The Meaning of Mu'min, or Believer 'Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, about, A Stt c? i&> V>& \jx uM b} iVerily, those who believe and those who are Jews and Christians, and Sabians, whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day^W * The obedient believers * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :198

249 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) that Allah revealed the following Ayah afterwards, j iL XX iX 'X.i (X-X) X- gX 4And whoever seeks religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted of him,

and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers> (3:85). This statement by Ibn ‘Abbas indicates that Allah does not accept any deed or work from anyone, unless it conforms to the Law of Muhammad jg that is, after Allah sent Muhammad Sfe. Before that, every person who followed the guidance of his own Prophet was on the correct path, following the correct guidance and was saved.

Why the Jews were called ‘Yahud’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 249]

The Jews are the followers of Prophet Musa, who used to refer to the Tawrah for judgment. Yahud is a word that means, ‘repenting’, just as Musa said, Certainly we have Hudna to You> meaning, we repent to You. This indicates that they were first called Yahud, because they repented and, because they were kind to each other. It was also said that they were called Yahud in reference to Yahuda (Judah) the eldest son of Prophet Ya'qub. Abu ‘Amr bin Al-‘Ala’ said that they were called Yahud, because they swayed when they read the Tawrah.

Why the Christians were called ‘Nasara’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 249–261]

When “Isa was sent, the Children of Israel were required to follow and obey him. The followers of Isa and his companions are called An-Nasdra, because they gave aid and support to each other. They are also called Ansar (helpers), as ‘Isa said, -iJli jii 4"Who will be my helpers in Allah's cause?" Al-Haivariyyun said : "We are the helpers ofAllah.">(61:14) It was said that they were called ‘Nasara’, because they inhabited a land called An-Nasirah (Nazareth), as Qatadah, Ibn

250 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jurayj and Ibn ‘Abbas were reported to have said , 11 Allah knows best. Nasara is certainly plural for Nasran. When Allah sent Muhammad as the Last and Final Prophet and Messenger to all of the Children of Adam, mankind was required to believe in him, obey him and refrain from what he prohibited them; those who do this are true believers. The Ummah of Muhammad was called ‘Mu’minin’ (believers), because of the depth of their faith and certainty, and because they believe in all of the previous Prophets and matters of the Unseen. The Sabi’un or Sabians There is a difference of opinion over the identity of the Sabians. Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that Layth bin Abu Sulaym said that Mujahid said that, “The Sabians are between the Majus, the Jews and the Christians. They do not have a specific religion.”*21 Similar is reported from Ibn Abi Najlh .*31 Similar statements were attributed to ‘Ata’ and Said bin Jubayr.*41 They (others) say that the Sabians are a sect among the People of the Book who used to read the Zabur (Psalms), others say that they are a people who worshipped the angels or the stars. It appears that the closest opinion to the truth, and Allah knows best, is Mujahid’s statement and those who agree with him like Wahb bin Munabbih, that the Sabians are neither Jews nor Christians nor MajOs nor polytheists. Rather, they did not have a specific religion that they followed and enforced, because they remained living according to their Fitrah (instinctual nature). This is why the idolators used .to call whoever embraced Islam a ‘Sabi’, meaning, that he abandoned all religions that existed on the earth. Some scholars stated that the Sabians are those who never received a message by any

Prophet. And Allah knows best. pi jJ> C \g% pZK Z \jSL 'jld pi G& pi jJa Jdli Sjli liij'i a oi i it 111 Ar-Razi 3 :97 *21 At-Tabari 2 :146 * Ibid. *41 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :199-200.

163. And (O Children of Israel, remember) when We took your covenant and We raised above you the Mount (saying) : "Hold fast to that which We have given you, and remember that which is therein so that you may acquire Taqwd> 164. Then after that you turned away. Had it not been for the grace and mercy of Allah upon you, indeed you would have been among the losers Taking the Covenant from the Jews Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the pledges, covenants and promises that He took from them to believe in Him alone, without a partner, and follow His Messengers. Allah stated that when He took their pledge from them, He raised the mountain above their heads, so that they affirm the pledge that they gave Allah and abide by it with sincerity and seriousness. Hence, Allah's statement, u !#0 St fsst t !4i« as jaas%&&s#S !f» idj iAtid (remember) when We raised the mountain over them as if it had been a canopy, and they thought that it was going to fall on them . (We said) : "Hold firmly to what We have given you (Tawrdh), and remember that which is therein (act on its commandments), so that you may fear Allah and obey Him.'% (7:171). The mount mentioned here is At-TQr, just as it was explained in Surat Al-A'raf according to the Tafsir of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ata', 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and others. 1 11 This is more obvious. There is another report from Ibn 'Abbas saying; The Tur is a type of mountain that vegetation grows on, if no vegetation grows on it, it is not called Tur.' And in the Hadith about the trials, Ibn 'Abbas said; "When they (the Jews) refused to obey, Allah raised the ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :203 121 Ibid.

252 Tafsir Ibn Kathir mountain above their heads so that they would listen." Al-Hasan said that Allah's statement, iHold fast to that which We have given you means, the Tawrah.*2 ' Mujahid said that the Ayah commanded, "Strictly adhere to it." * Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-Rabl' said that, in c \g%} iand remember that which is therein means, "Read the Tawrah and implement it." * Allah's statement, -Iji ft iThen after that you turned away. Had it not been far the grace of Allah> means, "Yet, after the firm pledge that you gave, you still deviated and broke your pledge"; iHad it not been far the grace and mercy of Allah upon you}, meaning, by forgiving you and by sending the Prophets and Messengers to you, 4Indeed you would have been among the losers meaning, in this life and the Hereafter due to their breach of the covenant. \yT-l \$ Oft 4 p* \Sx3 cji f, f& cfj 1*4 465. And indeed you knew tlwse amongst you who transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath (i.e. Saturday). We said to titan: "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected."} 466. SoWe made this punishment an examplefar those in front of it and those behind it, and a lesson far Al-Muttaqin (the pious.) *** An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd6 :396 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :204 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :205. * Ibid.

253Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) The Jews breach the Sanctity ofthe Sabbath Allah said, iAnd indeed you knew}. This Ayah means, O Jews! Remember that Allah sent His torment on the village that disobeyed Him and broke their pledge and their covenant to observe the sanctity of the Sabbath. They began using deceitful means to avoid honoring the Sabbath by placing nets, ropes and artificial pools of water for the purpose of fishing before the Sabbath. When the fish came in abundance on Saturday as usual, they were caught in the ropes and nets for the rest of Saturday. During the night, the Jews collected the fish after the Sabbath ended. When they did that, Allah changed them from humans into monkeys, the animals having the form closest to humans. Their evil deeds and deceit

appeared lawful on the surface, but they were in reality wicked. This is why their punishment was compatible with their crime. This story is explained in detail in Surat Al-A'raf, where Allah said (7:163), *And ask them (O Muhammad about the town that was by the sea; when they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath (i.e. Saturday): when their fish came to them openly on the Sabbath day, and did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath. Thus We made a trial of them, for they used to rebel (disobey Allah).}* (7: 163) In his Tafsir, Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, *And We said to them: "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected"* means, "Allah changed their bodies into those of monkeys and swines. The young people turned into monkeys while the old people turned into swine." * Shayban An-Nahwi reported that *hi Ibn Abi Hatim* 1 :210

254 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Qatadah commented on. *We said to them: "Be you monkeys, despised and rejected"*, "These people were turned into howling monkeys with tails, after being men and women."¹¹¹ The Monkeys and Swine that exist now are not the Descendants of Those that were transformed Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Those who violated the sanctity of the Sabbath were turned into monkeys, then they perished without offspring." ¹² Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah turned them into monkeys because of their sins. They only lived on the earth for three days, for no transformed person ever lives more than three days. They did not eat, drink or have offspring. Allah transformed their shapes into monkeys, and He does what He wills, with whom He wills and He changes the shape of whomever He wills. On the other hand, Allah created the monkeys, swines and the rest of the creation in the six days (of creation) that He mentioned in His Book."³ Allah's statement, *So We made this punishment an example* means, Allah made the people of this village, who violated the sanctity of the Sabbath, *an example* via the way they were punished. Similarly, Allah said about Pharaoh, *So Allah, seized him with punishing example for his last and first transgression* (79:25). Allah's statement, *Ibn Abi Hatim* 1 :209 ¹²¹ Ibid. ¹³¹ At-Jabari 2:167.

U) *If for those in front of it and those behind it* meaning, for the other villages. Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Meaning, *We made this village an example for the villages around it by the manner in which We punished its people.*" Similarly, Allah said, *And indeed We have destroyed towns (populations) round about you, and We have (repeatedly) shown (them) the Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) in various ways that they might return (to the truth and believe in the Oneness of Allah - Islamic Monotheism).* (46:27) Therefore, Allah made them an example for those who lived during their time as well as a reminder for those to come, by preserving their story. This is why Allah said, *and a lesson for the pious*}, meaning, a reminder. This Ayah means, "The torment and punishment that this village suffered was a result of indulging in Allah's prohibitions and their deceit. Hence, those who have Taqwa should be aware of their evil behavior, so that what occurred to this village does not befall them as well." Also, Imam Abu 'Abdullah bin Battah reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah *said*, *Do not commit what the Jews committed, breaching what Allah has forbidden, by resorting to the lowest types of deceit* This Hadith has a good [Jayid] chain of narration. Allah knows best. *And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "Verily, I am an Al-Gham* 5:375.

Allah commands you that you slaughter a cow." They said, "Do you make fun of us?" He said, "I take Allah's refuge from being among Al-Jdhilin (the ignorant or the foolish)."} The Story of the murdered Israeli Man and the Cow Allah said, 'O Children of Israel! Remember how I blessed you with miracle of the cow that was the means for discovering the identity of the murderer, when the murdered man was brought back to life.' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded T Baydah As-Salmani saying, "There was a man from among the Children of Israel who was impotent. He had substantial wealth, and only a nephew who would inherit from him. So his nephew killed him and moved his body at night, placing it at the doorstep of a certain man. The next morning, the nephew cried out for revenge, and the people took up their weapons and almost fought each other. The wise men among them said, 'Why would you kill each other, while the Messenger of Allah is still among you?' So they went to Musa and mentioned the matter to him and Musa said, or, o5P JVi tj. U>® 4"Verily, Allah commands you that you slaughter a cow." They said, "Do you make fun of us?" He said, "I take Allah's refuge from being among Al-Jahilin (the ignorant or the foolish).". "Had they not disputed, it would have been sufficient for them to slaughter any cow. However, they disputed, and the matter was made more difficult for them, until they ended up looking for the specific cow that they were later ordered to slaughter. They found the designated cow with a man, only who owned that cow. He said, "By Allah! I will only sell it for its skin's fill of gold.' So they paid the cow's fill of its skin in gold, slaughtered it and touched the dead man with a part of it. He stood up, and they asked him, 'Who killed you?' He said, 'That man,' and pointed to his nephew. He died again, and his nephew was not allowed to inherit him. Thereafter, whoever committed murder for the purpose of gaining inheritance was not allowed to inherit." Ibn Jarir reported something similar to that. Allah in Ibn Abi Ratim 1:114.

knows best.' ** t>: \$ J>: & js u £*. »> £ *5 ca f-^ ^pVii^iU'Ss'i^>1Oil ^ ^ ^ ^ ' ' ' *' / * >'. .? j>-.r ,r^ .• ^ <l%f w* *-> v • -"***^ r '{-.-^f-t -"i- ->—* H^y tr* •.- Juo C~3 ** fcy <J_^UUU.^SJuj*4^J}+ •> ^ ^ " s ^ iCJ U fal ij\i ^tJ<j3i j*vijijJ <Sij .. , , ', ,/.,, ?,^r-ffv > v-< dSi'i'i.-' ?r v-N)i'- ^ A" ot ji u u C5- 4lJi Lijj OjC5^<^U^tiij.^JL^C5l^ ^ jv jf, jg •£ j'gji jj 3ji ^ ?j£ a_>Lic.Li4_o \\$/i v i±2 ijb\p ^/^\ip^iir^jiSij\$ yi\ jfcs ^(_5"> 'jJ^ dj <\$6#. They said, ~— - — =*J "Call upon your Lord for us that He may make plain to us what it is!" He said, "He says, 'Verily, it is a cow neither too old nor too young, but (it is) between the two conditions', so do what you are commanded." } 469. They said, "Call upon your Lord for us to make plain to us its colour." He said, "He says, 'It is a ycllmo cow, bright in its colour, pleasing the beholders.' "\$> 470. They said, "Call upon your Lord for us to make plain to us what it is. Verily, to us all cows are alike. And surely, if Allah wills, we will be guided/> 471. He (Musa) said, "He says, 'It is a cow neither trained to At-Tabari 2 : 183 .

258 Tafstr Ibn Katfur till the soil nor water the fields, sound, having no blemish in it.' " They said, "Now you have brought the truth." So they slaughtered it though they were near to not doing it.} The Stubbornness of the Jews regarding the Cow; Allah made the Matter difficult for Them Allah mentioned the stubbornness of the Children of Israel and the many unnecessary questions they asked their Messengers. This is why when they were stubborn, Allah made the decisions difficult for them. Had they slaughtered a cow, any cow, it would have been sufficient for them, as Ibn 'Abbas and 'Ubaydah have said. Instead, they made the matter difficult, and this is why Allah made it even more difficult for them. They said, 4c£ £ icj Q fe\} iCall upon your Lord for us that He may make plain to us what it is!}, meaning, "What is this cow and what is its description?" Musa said, 4He says, 'Verily, it is a cmv

neither too old nor too young'}, meaning, that it is neither old nor below the age of breeding. This is the opinion of Abu Al-'Aliyah, As-Suddi, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, 'Ata', Al-Khurasani, Wahb bin Munabbih, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn 'Abbas. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4But (it is) between the two conditions} means, "Neither old nor young. Rather, she was at the age when the cow is strongest and fittest."¹²¹ In his Tafsir Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that, 4bright in its colour} "A deep yellowish white."¹³¹ 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:216. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 217. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :22 1

259 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) As-Suddi said, ipleasing the beholder meaning, that it pleases those who see it. ' This is also the opinion of Abu Al-'Aliyah, Qatadah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas.'² ' Furthermore, Wahb bin Munabbih said, "If you look at the cow's skin, you will think that the sun's rays radiate through its skin."³ ' The modern version of the Tawrah mentions that the cow in the Ayah was red, but this is an error. Or, it might be that the cow was so yellow that it appeared blackish or reddish in color. Allah's knows best. itS iVcrily, to us all cows are alike}* this means, that since cows are plentiful, then describe this cow for us further, \$Atid surely, ifAllah zvills} and if you further describe it to us, iwe xuill be guided uj— 1 'ij Jjb 'J JI iHe says, 'It is a cow neither trained to till the soil nor water the fields' meaning, it is not used in farming, or for watering purposes. Rather, it is honorable and fair looking. 'Abdur- Razzaq said that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said that, isound} means, "The cow does not suffer from any defects."⁴ ' This is also the opinion of Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-Rabl'. Mujahid also said that the Ayah means the cow is free from defects.*⁵ Further, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said that the Ayah means that its legs and body are free of physical defects.'⁶ ' ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :222. Ibid. At-Tabari 2 : 202 ' At-Tabari 2:214. ' At-Tabari 2 :225. At-Tabari 2:226.

Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, 4d^J^i 'j Cj llyi iSo they slaughtered it though they were near to not doing it} means, "They did not want to slaughter it." This means that even after all the questions and answers about the cow's description, the Jews were still reluctant to slaughter the cow. This part of the Qur'an criticized the Jews for their behavior, because their only goal was to be stubborn, and this is why they nearly did not slaughter the cow. Also, 'Ubaydah, Mujahid, Wahb bin Munabbih, Abu Al-'Aliyah and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "The Jews bought the cow with a large amount of money."²¹ There is a difference of opinion over this. Iliii U l—ii yT'.i 4ff?jyili JjJi iit t/J 472. And (remember) when you killed a man and disagreed among yourselves as to the crime. But Allah brought forth that which you were Taktumun .} 473. So We said: "Strike him (the dead man) with a piece of it (the cow)." Thus Allah brings the dead to life and shows you His Ayat (proofs, evidences, etc.) so that you may understand.} Bringing the murdered Man back to Life Al-Bukhari said that, 4^ (wij'ili} 4And disagreed among yourselves as to the crime means, "Disputed." This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid. 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and Ad- Dahhak said, "Disputed about this matter." 141 Also, Ibn Jurayj said that, 111 At-Jabari 2:219. 121 At-Jabari 2:221. 131 Fath Al-Bari 6 :506 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :229

itri £2M iAud (remember) when you killed a man and disagreed among yourselves as to the crime means, some of them said, "You killed him," while the others said, "No you killed him." 1 11 This is also

the Tafsir of 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin AslamJ21 Mujahid

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 261–269]

said that, 4'oJ&p M 4But Allah brought forth that which you were Taktumun means, “what you were hiding.”¹³¹ Allah said, 4So We said: "Strike him (the dead man) with a piece of it (the cow)" } meaning, “any part of the cow will produce the miracle (if they struck the dead man with it).” We were not told which part of the cow they used, as this matter does not benefit us either in matters of life or religion. Otherwise, Allah would have made it clear for us. Instead, Allah made this matter vague, so this is why we should leave it vague. Allah’s statement, iTltus Allah brings the dead to life^ means, “They struck him with it, and he came back to life.” This Ayah demonstrates Allah’s ability in bringing the dead back to life. Allah made this incident proof against the Jews that the Resurrection shall occur, and ended their disputing and stubbornness over the dead person. Allah mentioned His bringing the dead back to life in five instances in Surat Al-Baqarah. First Allah said, 4j ?¥ 4Then We raised you up after your death}- He then mentioned the story about the cow. Allah also mentioned the story of those who escaped death in their land, while they were numbering in 111 At-Tabari 2 :225 At-Tabari 2:225. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :229

the thousands. He also mentioned the story of the Prophet who passed by a village that was destroyed, the story of Abraham and the four birds, and the land that comes back to life after it has died. All these incidents and stories alert us to the fact that bodies shall again become whole, after they were rotten. The proof of Resurrection is also reiterated in Allah’s statement, eft L»j £ ft ftftj ft % n a* Hf, Jt 9^ 4:\$&i£dS \$3 kJfl 4And a sign for them is the dead land We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof. And We have made therein gardens of date palms and grapes, and We have caused springs of water to gush forth therein . So that they may eat of the fruit thereof - and their hands made it not. Will they not then give thanks?) (36:33-35). 'JAA iJ YAf of jl ijUi.s' ft I? fojjb ftli y) ft <ii(Y~*~ Si -1ft tJ ft a'j ft jftj 3ft 1-J ft vj ft 474. T/ie/i after that your hearts were hardened and became as stones or even worse in hardness. And indeed, there are stones out of which rivers gush forth, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which split asunder so that ivaterfloios from them, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which fall down for fear of Allah. And Allah is not unaware of what you do.) The Harshness of the Jews Allah criticized the Children of Israel because they witnessed the tremendous signs and the Ayat of Allah, including bringing the dead back to life, yet, i# ft * y) iThen after that your hearts were hardened). So their hearts were like stones that never become soft. This is why Allah forbade the believers from imitating the Jews when He said,

yj 'ij j£' Jt 4> '-“j ^i==yJ c? '>*' # ^5 £>* &(iHa\$ not the time come for the hearts of those who believe (in the Oneness of Allah - Islamic Monotheism) to be affected by Allah's Reminder (this Qur'an), and that which has been revealed of the truth, lest they become as those who received the Scripture (the Tawrah) and the Injtl (Gospel)) before (i.e. Jews and Christians), and the term was prolonged for them and so their hearts were hardened? And many of them were Fdsiqun (the rebellious, the disobedient to Allah)} (57:16). In his Tafsir, Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “When the dead man was struck with a part of the cow, he stood up and became more alive than he ever was. He was asked, Who killed you?’ He said, ‘My nephews killed me.’ He then died again. His nephews said, after Allah took his life away, By Allah! We did not kill him’ and denied the truth while they knew it. Allah said, Vj£j% iAnd

became as stones or even worse in hardness And by the passage of time, the hearts of the Children of Israel were unlikely to accept any admonishment, even after the miracles and signs they witnessed. Their hearts became harder than stones, with no hope of ever softening. Sometimes, springs and rivers burst out of stones, some stones split and water comes out of them, even if there are no springs or rivers around them, sometimes stones fall down from mountaintops out of their fear of Allah. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, [^] u!j itU* C* gfhA 6}j A+At' CJ YAAAf St YSA [^] U iAnd indeed, there are stones out of which rivers gush forth, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which split asunder so that water flows from them, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which fall m At-Jabari 2 :234

down for fear of Allah}, means, “Some stones are softer than your hearts, they acknowledge the truth that you are being called to, lli ill Cj} iAnd Allah is not unaware of what you Solid Inanimate Objects possess a certain Degree of Awareness Some claimed that the Ayat mentioned the stones being humble as a metaphor. However, Ar-Razi, Al-Qurtubi and other Imams said that there is no need for this explanation, because Allah creates this characteristic - humbleness - in stones. For instance, Allah said, iTruly, We did offer Al-Amnah (the trust) to the heavens and the earth, and the mountains, but they declined to bear it and were afraid of it (i.e. afraid of Allah's torment)} (33:72), 4ti iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him (17:44), iAnd the stars and the trees both prostrate themselves (to Allah)} (55:6), 4Have they not observed things that Allah has created: (how) their shadows incline} (16:48), iThey both said: “We come willingly.”} (41:11), iHad We sent down this Qur’an on a mountain} (59:21), and. m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :233

265 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (50 - 74) (Part-1) 4And they will say to their skins, "Why do you testify against us?" They will say: “Allah has caused us to speak.”} (41:21). It is recorded in the Sahih that the Prophet jg said, tt „, “77*is (Mount Uhud) is amount that loves us and that we love. ll] Similarly, the compassion of the stump of the palm tree for the Prophet jg as confirmed in authentic narrations. In Sahih Muslim it is recorded that the Prophet sg said, 43^V J-3 Jjip p i .-> jli jPy>- </ fcnw rt stone in Makkah that used to greet me with the Salām before I was sent. I recognize this stone now M2 He said about the Black Stone that, aOn the Day of Resurrection it will testify for those who kiss it .nl31 There are several other texts with this meaning. The scholars of the Arabic language disagreed over the meaning of Allah’s statement, [^] j' {jvf} 4And became as stones or even worse in hardness after agreeing that ‘or’ here is not being used to reflect doubt. Some scholars said that ‘or’ here means, ‘and’. So the meaning becomes, “As hard as stones, and harder.” For instance, Allah said, AfjJZ & 1 * {r; £4" Vj} iAnd obey not a sinner or a disbeliever among them} (76:24), and, i:f:&)&} 111 Fath Al-BQri 6 : 98 121 Muslim 3:1782. I3 ' Ahmad 1 :266.

266 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4To cut off all excuses or to warn} (77:6). Some other scholars said that ‘or’ here means, ‘rather’. Hence, the meaning becomes, ‘As hard as stones. Rather, harder.’ For instance, Allah said, ii.1 jl il 'M i* f x \ 4A section of them fear men as they fear Allah or even more) (4:77), 'iv . \$ ijil iiL 4And We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more} (37:147), and, *T>li o&*) 4And so as at a distance of two bows' length or (even) nearer (53:9). Some other scholars said that this Ayah means their hearts are only of two types, as hard as stone or harder than stone. Further, Ibn Jarir commented that this Tafsir means that some of their hearts are as hard as stone and some hearts are

harder than stone.¹¹¹ Ibn Jarir said that he favored this last Tafsir, although the others are plausible. I - Ibn Kathir - say that the last Tafsir is similar to Allah's statement, *their likeness is as the likeness of one who kindled a fire* (2:17), and then His statement, *Or like a rainstorm from the sky* (2:19). It is also similar to Allah's statement, *As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert* (24:39), and then His statement, *At-Jabari 2 :236*.

267 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) *Or (the state of a disbeliever) is like the darkness in a vast deep sea* (24:40). This then means that some of them are like the first example, and some others are like the second example. Allah knows best. *Do you (faithful believers) covet that they will believe in your religion in spite of the fact that a party of them (Jewish rabbis) used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it knowingly after they understood it?* 476. And when they (Jews) meet those who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe," but when they meet one another in private, they say, "Shall you (Jews) tell them (Muslims) what Allah has revealed to you that they (Muslims) may argue with you (Jews) about it before your Lord?" Have you (Jews) then no understanding? 477. *Know they (Jews) not that Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal?* There was little Hope that the Jews Who lived during the Time of the Prophet *could have believed Allah said, 'Do you covet) O believers, that they will believe in your religion)* meaning, that these people would obey you? They are the deviant sect of Jews whose fathers witnessed the clear signs but their hearts became hard afterwards. Allah said next,

*In spite of the fact that a party of them (Jewish rabbis) used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it} meaning, distort its meaning, after they understood it}. They understood well, yet they used to defy the truth, knowingly}, being fully aware of their erroneous interpretations and corruption. This statement is similar to Allah's statement, *So, because of their violation of their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts grow hard. They change the words from their (right) places* (5:13). Qatadah commented that Allah's statement; *Then they used to change it knowingly after they understood it} "They are the Jews who used to hear Allah's Words and then alter them after they understood and comprehended them."* Also, Mujahid said, "Those who used to alter it and conceal its J y iiBjigP L IXA- 1" j pJ !Aj@J 'j b '<Jjj£ Jr 1 ^*j I Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 236*

269 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1 truths; they were their scholars." * Also, Ibn Wahb said that Ibn Zayd commented, *used to hear the Word of Allah (the Tawrah), then they used to change it} "They altered the Tawrah that Allah revealed to them, making it say that the lawful is unlawful and the prohibited is allowed, and that what is right is false and that what is false is right. So when a person seeking the truth comes to them with a bribe, they judge his case by the Book of Allah, but when a person comes to them seeking to do evil with a bribe, they take out the other (distorted) book, in which it is stated that he is in the right. When someone comes to them who is not seeking*

what is right, nor offering them bribe, then they enjoin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 269–285]

righteousness on him. This is why Allah said to them, iEnjoin you Al-Birr (piety and righteousness and every act of obedience to Allah) on the people and you forget (to practise it) yourselves, while you recite the Scripture (the Tawrdh)! Have you then no sense?} (2:44)” [21 The Jews knew the Truth of the Prophet but disbelieved inHim Allah said next, d) f I 4And when they (Jews) meet tlwse who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe", but when they meet one another in private..}. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, i&\: \$6 \JS\> >_£> \i\j,} 4And when they (Jews) meet those who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe"} “They believe that Muhammad sfe is the Messenger of Allah, “But he was only sent for you (Arabs)””131 However, when they meet each other they say, “Do not convey 111 At-Tabari 2:245. 121 At-Tabari 2:246. 131 At-Tabari 2 :250

270 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the news about this Prophet to the Arabs, because you used to ask Allah to grant you victory over them when he came, but he was sent to them (not to you).” Allah then revealed, ^ uj“? d) VL lijj &l» Ijlli \ySXt jji \fo lij 4A«rf when they (Jews) meet those who believe (Muslims), they say, "We believe," but when they meet one another in private, they say, ",Shall you (Jews) tell them (Muslims) what Allah has revealed to you, that they (Muslims) may argue with you (Jews) about it before your Lord?"} meaning, “If you admit to them that he is a Prophet, knowing that Allah took the covenant from you to follow him, they will know that Muhammad is the Prophet that we were waiting for and whose coming we find foretold of in our Book. Therefore, do not believe in him and deny him.” Allah said, iKtiow they (Jeivs) not that Allah ktmvs what they conceal and what they reveal?}. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “When the Jews met the believers they used to say, “We believe.’ When they met each other, some of them would say, ‘Do not talk to the companions of Muhammad about what Allah has foretold in your Book, so that the news (that Muhammad is the Final Messenger) does not become a proof for them against you with your Lord, and, thus, you will win the dispute.””111 Further, Abu Al-‘Aliyah said about Allah’s statement, ^ v v 'o>4~. Uj l* o1 ijjJLu yj)} iKnow they (Jews) not that Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal?}, “Meaning their secret denial and rejection of Muhammad, sg although they find his coming recorded in their Book.” This is also the Tafsir of Qatadah. Al-Hasan commented on, &pA 'A \$} m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :239

272Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iThat Allah knows what they conceal}, “What they concealed refers to when they were alone with each other away from the Companions of Muhammad jg. Then they would forbid each other from conveying the news that Allah revealed to them in their Book to the Companions of Muhammad jg, fearing that the Companions would use this news (about the truth of Muhammad jg) against them before their Lord.” iAnd what they reveal?} meaning, when they said to the Companions ofMuhammad jg, i&\.'} 4We believe}, as Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' and Qatadah stated. bM ^1 ,U & U\$ % O0, (4^ Jeii ^4^ ^4 475. And f/iere are among than (Jews) 'Ummyyun (unlettered) people, who know not the Book, but they trust upon Amdni (false desires) and they but guess.} 479. Then woe to those who write the book with their own hands and then say, "This isfrom Allah," to purchase with it a little price! Woe to than for what their hands have written and woe to them for that they earn thereby.}

The Meaning of‘UmmV Allah said, iAnd there are among them Ummyyun people} meaning, among the People of the Book, as Mujahid stated. Ummyyun, is plural for Ummi, that is, a person who does

not write, as Abu Al- ‘Aliyah, Ar-RabT, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and others said. This meaning is clarified by Allah’s statement, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :240. 121 Ibid.

\$Who know not the Booty meaning, are they not aware of what is in it.' Ummi was one of the descriptions of the Prophet because he was unlettered. For instance, Allah said, 4Neither did you (O Muhammad read any book before it (this Qur'an) nor did you write any book (whatsoever) with your right hand. In that case, indeed, the followers of falsehood might have doubted} (29:48). Also, the Prophet said, lislaj lisci Jl UjB “We are an Ummi nation, neither writing nor calculating. The (lunar) month is like this, this and this (i.e. thirty or twenty- nine days .»'2' This liadlth stated that Muslims do not need to rely on books, or calculations to decide the timings of their acts of worship. Allah also said, 4^4 4 44 >sM Jty iHe it is Who sent among the Ummiyyim ones a Messenger (Muhammad \$fe)from among themselves} (62:2). The Explanation of Amani Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement, i'Oit.) 4But they trust upon Amani} means, “It is just a false statement that they utter with their tongues. It was also said that Amani means Visiles and hopes’. Mujahid commented, “Allah described the Ummiyyin as not understanding any of the Book that Allah sent down to Musa, yet they create lies and * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :241 •2| Path Al-Bari 4:151. At-Tabari 2 :261

273 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) falsehood.” * Therefore, the word Amani mentioned here refers to lying and falsehood. Mujahid said that Allah’s statement, iU& Vi ,U <&>• {And they but guess} means, “They lie.” ’ Qatadah, Abu Al- ‘Aliyah and Ar-Rabl’ said that it means, “They have evil false ideas about Allah.”131 Woe unto Those Criminals among the Jews Allah said, L— »*_> 'jLA-i-J xe. IJCa jj5yu jU 4-4S3'* 4 ul-tii 54**^ iThen Waylun (woe) to those who write the book with their own hands and then say, "This is from Allah," to purchase with it a little price!}. This is another category of people among the Jews who called to misguidance with falsehood and lies about Allah, thriving on unjustly amassing people’s property. ‘Waylun (woe)’ carries meanings of destruction and perishing, and it is a well- known word in the Arabic language. Az-Zuhri said that Tjbadydullah bin ‘Abdullah narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “O Muslims! How could you ask the People of the Book about anything, while the Book of Allah (Qur'an) that He revealed to His Prophet jfc is the most recent Book from Him and you still read it fresh and young? Allah told you that the People of the Book altered the Book of Allah, changed it and wrote another book with their own hands. They then said, This book is from Allah,’ so that they acquired a small profit by it. Hasn’t the knowledge that came to you prohibited you from asking them? By Allah! We have not seen any of them asking you about what was revealed to you.”*4 ’ This Hadith was also collected by Al- Bukhari.*5 * Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “The little amount here 111 At-Jabari 2:262. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :242. * Ibid. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :245. 151 Path Al-Bari 5 :244 , 13 :345& 555

means this life and all that it contains.” Allah’s statement, iWoe to them for what their hands have written and woe to them for that they earn thereby^ means, “Woe to them because of what they have written with their own hands, the lies, falsehood and alterations. Woe to them because of the property that they unjustly acquired.” Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, iWoe to them}, “Means the torment will be theirs because of the lies that they wrote with their own hands, iOjLJZ lij^ jj, 4And woe to them for that they earn thereby}, which they unjustly acquired from people, be they commoners or otherwise.”*2 ii' Jii \x+l -if jcc Jrjcl ji jl^Slf l: J J 4 i' *f l; . rJi- i& 480. And they (Jews) say, "The Fire

shall not touch us but for a few numbered days." Say (O Muhammad jg to them): "Have you taken a covenant from Allah, so that Allah will not break His covenant? Or is it that you say of Allah what you know not?"} The Jews hope They will only remain in the Fire for a Few Days Allah mentioned the claim of the Jews, that the Fire will only touch them for a few days, and then they will be saved from it. Allah refuted this claim by saying, -if JC* Jriitfl j>^ 4Say (O Mulmmmad jg to them) : "Have you taken a covenant from 1,1 Ibn Abi HAtim 1 :247. At-Jabari 2:273.

275 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) Allah?\$. Hence, the Ayah proclaims, 'if you had a promise from Allah for that, then Allah will never break His promise. However, such promise never existed. Rather, what you say, about Allah, you have no knowledge of and you thus utter a lie about Him.' Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said about the Ayah, 4And they (Jews) say, "The Fire shall not touch us but for a few numbered days "The Jews said, The Fire will only touch us for forty days. ""T' 1 Others added that this was the period during which the Jews worshipped the calf. Also, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah reported Abu Hurayrah saying, 4)l\ Jlii i. aLt \$^5? taj j-* 1 ?&' JUi -'£f I 'j* jli If J • ^ jyj @ jj\ ! JIS IjJLS illL'iiS j|3 t' U : L_>Hi j| ^ i'B jtJl jii <ul Jj-^j ^ Jlii iLi ILS cJ^p 4il_> lyU^U ail J_^j pjJ JUS IfJ jif '3rri 4^ j_j& JJ j>-(J Jii jJ .aijJl V JVU2. allJl ajia @ :Jli Ul IS : l_pli jiSolLi ji Cits' <llS jl HjJlii p£SjL>- Lilt :JLS :l^5lii ' ; J ^ ' , ,» • _ ' , _ „ - . Ilj (jjj "fvfjvti Khaybar was conquered, a roasted poisoned sheep was presented to the Prophet -fe as a gift (by the Jews). The Messenger of Allah jfe ordered, 'Assemble before me all the Jews who were here.' The Jews were summoned and the Prophet jg said (to them), 'Who is your father?' They replied, 'So-and-so.' He said, 'You have lied; your father is so-and-so.' They said, 'You have uttered the truth.' He said, "Will you now tell me the truth, if I ask you about something?' They replied, 'Yes, O (il At-Jabari 2 :276

276 Tafsir ton Kathir Abul-Qasim; and if we should tell a lie, you will know our lie as you have about our fathers.' On that he asked, Who are the people of the (Hell) Fire?' They said. We shall remain in the (Hell) Fire for a short period, and after that you will replace us in it.' The Prophet gg said, 'May you be cursed and humiliated in it! By Allah, we shall never replace you in it.' Tlten he asked, Will you tell me the truth if I ask you a question?' They said, 'Yes, O Abul-Qasim.' He asked, 'Have you poisoned this sheep?' They said, 'Yes.' He asked, What made you do so?' They said, We wanted to know if you were a liar, in which case we would get rid of you, and if you were a Prophet then the poison would not harm i/ow.n Imam Ahmad, Al- Bukhari and An-Nasa'i recorded similarly.121 r.luuu f. >Ljj jv* /.*» «. tfil liUdj1 181. Yes! Wltosoever earns evil and his sin has surrounded him, they are dwellers of the Fire (i.e. Hell); they will dwell therein forever}. 182. And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, they are dwellers of Paradise, they will dwell therein forever.} Allah says, the matter is not as you have wished and hoped it to be. Rather, whoever does an evil deed and abides purposefully in his error, coming on the Day of Resurrection with no good deeds, only evil deeds, then he will be among the people of the Fire. jp\; <ZsMj} iAnd those who believe and do righteous good deeds} meaning, "They believe in Allah and His Messenger sg and perform the good deeds that conform with the Islamic Law. They shall be among the people of Paradise." Allah said in a similar statement, l 1 ' Dala'ilAn-Nubuwwah 4 :256. Ahmad 2:451, Fath At-Bari 6:314, and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra

Oi 'ij •** '*jr* y>P jifcjSut > *>" c.1 4 <* < ^ ^ << , M/ / .</ * if > Crf*4 >*J l>* y Ot s^r»J W' JJ LJJ 4i>l UJJ 4""C!/ij Ojiiiu iX*> ilt will not be in accordance with your desires (Muslims), nor those of the

People of the Scripture (Jews and Qiristians), whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, and he will not find any protector or helper besides Allah. And whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a (true) believer [in the Oneness of Allah (Muslim)], such will enter Paradise and not the least injustice, even the size of a Naqira (speck on the back of a date stone), will be done to them) {4:123-124). Also, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Wa'il, 'Ata', and Al-Hasan said that, *4i 4A)id his sin has surrounded him) means, "His Shirk (polytheism) has surrounded him."¹¹¹ Also, Al-A'mash reported from Abu Razin that Ar-Rabl' bin Khuthaym said, 4And his sin has surrounded him), "Whoever dies before repenting from his wrongs."² As-Suddi and Abu Razin said similarly.*³ Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said that, 4Attd his sin has surrounded him) refers to major sins.*⁴ * All of these statements carry similar meanings, and Allah knows best. When Small Sins gather, They bring about Destruction Here we should mention the Hadith that Imam Ahmad [1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1:252. (2 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :252. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253

recorded, in which 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, «Beware of the belittled sins, because they gather on a person until they destroy him .« He then said that the Messenger of Allah ag; gave them an example, I U I li ljU I I OjjJL j «77iis is tlte example ofpeople who set up camp on a flat land, and then their servants came. One of them collected some wood and another man collected some wood until they collected a great deal. They then started a fire and cooked what they put on Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4Ami those who believe and do righteous good deeds, they are dwellers ofParadise, they will dwell therein forever "Whoever believes in what you (Jews) did not believe in and implements what you refrained from implementing of Muhammad's religion, shall acquire Paradise for eternity. Allah stated that the recompense for good or evil works shall remain with its people for eternity."¹² ' \$£& lS}j C/j)9Vj Si' OjiLw "J} ^lj3 'g. \y£=sr)\ \jtlj if . ! A»*J t ".Ifj i83. And (remember) when We took a covenant from the Children of Israel, (saying): Worship none but Alldh (alone) and be dutiful and good to parents, and to kindred, and to orphans and (the poor), and speak good to people and perform As-Salah and give Zakah . Then you slid back, except a few of 111 Ahmad 1 :204. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :254.

you, ivhile you are backsliders.} The Covenant that Allah took from the Children of Israel Allah reminded the Children of Israel of the commandments that He gave them, and the covenants that He took from them to abide by those commands, and how they intentionally and knowingly turned away from all of that. Allah commanded them to worship Him and to associate none with Him in worship, just as He has commanded all of His creatures, for this is why Allah created them. Allah said. "0 V iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad s&) but We revealed to him (saying) : La ilaha ilia Ana [none has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah)], so worship Me (alone and none else)} (21:25), and, Si' iil 4 X&f} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah (community, nation) a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (alone), and avoid the Tdghilt (allfalse deities,)} (16:36). This is the highest and most important right, that is, Allah's right that He be worshipped alone without partners. After that comes the right of the creatures, foremost, the right of the parents. Allah usually mentions the rights of the parents along with His rights. For instance, Allah said, iXJd (j[AJjjJ J jk=d\ oty iGive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination} (31:14). Also, Allah said. iAnd your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents} (17:23), until, iAnd give to the kinsman his due and to the MiskTn (poor) and to the wayfarer} (17:26).

The Two Sahihs record that Ibn Mas‘ud said, p :oii *1 {Js- :JU U* :oii «jil J : Jli p :c~ii «jJjJlJ3l : JIS «/ said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! What is the best deed?’ He said, ‘Performing the prayer on time.’ I said, ‘Then ivhat?’ He said, ‘Being kind to one’s parents.’ I said, ‘Then what?’ He said, ‘jihad in the cause of Allah .’s 1 Allah then said, iand to orphans meaning, the young who have no fathers to fend for them. iand Al-Masakin (the poor)}, plural for Miskin, the one who does not find what he needs to spend on himself and his family. We will discuss these categories when we explain the Ayah of Surat An-Nisa‘where Allah said, iWorship Allah and join none with Him (in worship); and do good to parents} (4:36). Allah’s statement, ‘j*A>^ iand speak good to people} meaning, say good words to them and be lenient with them, this includes commanding good and forbidding evil. Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on Allah’s statement, i‘LZ. o-llu y&} iand speak good to people}, “ The good saying’ means commanding good and forbidding evil, and being patient and forgiving. The ‘good words to people’, as Allah commanded, also includes every good type of behavior that Allah is pleased with. "I21 Imam Ahmad narrated that Abu Dharr said that the FathAl-Bari 6:5, and Muslim 1 :89. 2| IbnAbiHatim 1:258.

281Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) Prophet jgj said, p jtj U<i jyL>w “Do «of belittle anyform of righteousness, and even ifyou did not find any good deed except meeting your brother with a smiling face, then do so . This Hadith was also collected by Muslim in his Sahih and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it SahihJ Allah commands the servants to say good words to people, after He commanded them to be kind to them, thereby mentioning two categories of manners: good speech and good actions. He then emphasized the command to worship Him and the command to do good, ordaining the prayer and the Zakah, iand perform As-Salah and give Zakah\$. Allah informed us that the People of the Book, except for a few among them, ignored these orders, that is, they knowingly and intentionally abandoned them. Allah ordered this Ummah similarly in Surat An-Nisa’when He said, ijT4% s& \j52Xfr J K jCSfo &2X jj A’S U *&k 4Worship Allah and join none with Him (in worship); and do good to parents, kinsfolk, orphans, Al-Masdkin (the poor), the neighbor who is near ofkin, the neighbor who is a stranger, the companion by your side, the wayfarer (you meet), and tlwse (servants) whom your right hands possess. Verily, Allah does not like such as are proud and boastful^ (4:36). Of these orders, this Ummah has practiced what no other nation before it has, and all praise is due to Allah. } pA-i as ^ f &A * P&A \$£& rO/Zi oi j&i &j* ’oyrffoj p ^ m Ahmad 5 : 173 , Muslim 4 :2026 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :526

J maz 'r «® 'oJrjZ'j'jp&i ilj ^ *-» f-' •-> V ^ « V«^ I*p oj' uiijii'j jf oipi • A. •< \$'s> sy s • * > , "T- i -- <1-xL\c.{ 'r^ .yttjp-s>jA_ju j b-C&jC^W&* \$ ojl£4 iiijjtj ^-•CJV?^ J&its^£*5 ffriL&l2*Jftgf Jippi »ia ^ii jf^'v («*& y>j tfyi' (Syfc p'A & 'fit r > ;£<1 l _ ^ * ijfULyJ' ii tf> tli ^aiL. iyjJiS2j 2^ ^1 r^i <£*" ,/ -'.ff r& u'5li y£jt 4 Aii\ Uj 4 if, ytuit iJi cySjj iMp|JLjU Li-C* L^ *^ Uj!» ij/if Ijjif n* J&4 Su th% (7/ iis) you ratified and (to this) you bore witness. i • . >* > •> <- p* JJ <84. And (remember) when VJe took your covenant (saying): Shed not the blood of your (people), nor turn out your own people from their dwellings. Then, 485. After this, it is you xoho kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes, assist (their enemies) against them, in sin and transgression. And if they come to you as captives, you ransom them, although their expulsion was forbidden to you . Then do you believe in a part of the Book and reject the rest? Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world, and on the Day of Resurrection they shall be consigned to the most grievous torment. And Allah is not unaware ofwhat you do.} 486. Tlwse are they who have bought

the life of this world at the price of the Hereafter. Their torment shall not be lightened nor shall they be helped.}

283 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) The Terms of the Covenant and their Breach of It Allah criticized the Jews who lived in Al-Madlneh during the time of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. They used to suffer, because of the armed conflicts between the tribes of Al-Madlneh, Aws and Khazraj. Before Islam, the Aws and Khazraj worshipped idols, and many battles took place between them. There were three Jewish tribes in Al-Madlneh at that time, Banu Qaynuqa and Banu An-Nadlr, the allies of the Khazraj, and Banu Qurayzah, who used to be the allies of the Aws. When war erupted between Aws and Khazraj, their Jewish allies would assist them. The Jew would kill his Arab enemy, and sometimes they also killed Jews who were the allies of the other Arab tribe, although the Jews were prohibited from killing each other according to clear religious texts in their Books. They would also drive each other from their homes and loot whatever furniture and money they could. When the war ended, the victorious Jews would release the prisoners from the defeated party, according to the rulings of the Tawrah. This is why Allah said, {Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest?} Allah said, {And (remember) when We took your covenant (saying) : Shed not the blood of your (people), nor turn out your own people from their dwellings.} meaning, “Do not kill each other, nor expel one another from their homes, nor participate in fighting against them.” Allah mentioned the word ‘your own’ here, just as He said in another Ayah. {So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves, that will be better for you with your Creator (2:54) because the followers of one religion are just like one soul. Also, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said,

284 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jj 1 1j L yU* J ^pljLJ jyafr «C. “The example of the believers in their kindness, mercy and sympathy to each other is the example of one body, when an organ of it falls ill, the rest of the body rushes to its aid in fever and sleeplessness.^ Allah’s statement, {Then, (this) you ratified and (to this) you bore witness.} means, “You testified that you know of the covenant and that you were witnesses to it.” jXj \uufi byffe-j Si’p, ^1\ iAfter this, it is you who kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes}. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, {After this, it is you who kill one another and drive out a party of you from their homes} “Allah mentioned what they were doing, and that in the Tawrah He had prohibited them from shedding each other’s blood, and required them to free their prisoners. Now they were divided into two camps in Al-Madlneh, Banu Qaynuqa*, who were the allies of the Khazraj, and An-Nadir and Qurayzah, who were the allies of the Aws. When fighting erupted between Aws and Khazraj, Banu Qaynuqa* would fight along with the Khazraj, while Banu An-Nadir and Qurayzah would fight along with the Aws. Each Jewish camp would fight against their Jewish brethren from the other camp. They would shed each other’s blood, although they had the Tawrah with them, and they knew their rights and dues. Meanwhile, the Aws and Khazraj were polytheists who worshipped idols. They did not know about Paradise, the Fire, Resurrection, Divine Books the lawful and prohibited. When the war would end, the Jews would ransom their prisoners and implement 111 Muslim 4:1999. 121 Ibn Abi H&tim 1 :261

the Tawrah. Consequently, Banu Qaynuqa' would ransom their prisoners who were captured by the Aws, while Banu An-Nadir and Qurayzah would ransom their prisoners who were captured by the

Khazraj. They would also ask for blood money. During these wars, they would kill whomever (Jews or Arabs) they could, while helping the polytheists against their brethren. Therefore, Allah reminded them of this when He said, 'Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest?' ^ This Ayah means, 'Do you ransom them according to the rulings of the Tawrah, yet kill them while the Tawrah forbade you from killing them and from expelling them from their homes? The Tawrah also commanded that you should not aid the polytheists and those who associate with Allah in the worship against your brethren. You do all this to acquire the life of this world.' I was informed that the behavior of the Jews

regarding the Aws and Khazraj was the reason behind

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 285–313]

revealing these Ayat.” These noble Ayat criticized the Jews for implementing the Tawrah sometimes and defying it at other times, although they believed in the Tawrah and knew what they were doing was wrong. This is why they should not be trusted to preserve or convey the Tawrah. Further, they should not be believed when it comes to the description of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, his coming, his expulsion from his land, and his Hijrah, and the rest of the information that the previous Prophets informed them about him, all of which they hid. The Jews, may they suffer the curse of Allah, hid all of these facts among themselves, and this is why Allah said, 'Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world', because they defied Allah's Law and commandments, 44>'i*R\$ d! ilia' '{£>} iAnd on the Day of Resurrection tthey shall be consigned to the most grievous torment} as punishment for defying the Book of Allah

287Surah 2. Al-Bagarah (75 - 100) (Part-1 4 Verily, We did reveal the Tawrah (to Musa), therein was guidance and light, by which the Prophets, who submitted themselves to Allah's will, judged for the jews. And the rabbis and the priests (too judged for the Jews by the Tawrah after those Prophets), for to them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they were witnesses thereto} (5:44). This is why Allah said here, iAnd Qaffayna him with Messengers}. As-Suddi said that Abu Malik said that Qaffayna. means, “Succeeded” , while others said, “Followed”. Both meanings are plausible, since Allah said, l£J (Cj ?) iThen We sent Our Messengers in succession} (23:44). Thereafter, Allah sent the last Prophet among the Children of Israel, Isa the son of Mary, who was sent with some laws that differed with some in the Tawrah. This is why Allah also sent miracles to support ‘Isa. These included bringing the dead back to life, forming the shape of birds from clay and blowing into them, afterwhich they became living birds by Allah’s leave, healing the sick and foretelling the Unseen, as Ibn ‘Abbas stated. 121 Allah also aided him with Rah Al-Qudus, and that refers to Jibril. All of these signs testified to the truthfulness of ‘Isa and what he was sent with. Yet, the Children of Israel became more defiant and envious of him and did not want to differ with even one part of the Tawrah, as Allah said about Isa, (J-i- JJS 0-?%) iAnd to make lawful to you part ofwhat was forbidden to you, and I have come to you with a proof from your Lord} (3:50). Hence, the Children of Israel treated the Prophets in the worst manner, rejecting some of them and killing some of them. All of this occurred because the Prophets used to 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :268. 121 Ibid.

command the Jews with what differed from their desires and opinions. The Prophets also upheld the rulings of the Tawrah that the Jews had changed, and this is why it was difficult for them to believe in these Prophets. Therefore, they rejected the Prophets and killed some of them. Allah said, 'ijjj y Hj d&\} il\$ it that whenever there came to you a Messenger with what you yourselves desired not, you grew arrogant? Some you disbelieved and some you kill}. Jibril is Ruh Al-Qudus The proof that Jibril is the Ruh Al-Qudus is the statement of Ibn Mas'ud in explanation of this Ayah. ' This is also the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Ismail bin Khalid, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi and Qatadah.'² Additionally, Allah said. iWhich the trustworthy Ruh (Jibril) has brought down. Upon your heart (O Muhammad jfej that you may be (one) of the warners (26:193-194). Al-Bukhari recorded 'A'ishah saying that the Messenger of Allah gfe erected a Minbar in the Masjid on which Hassan bin Thabit (the renowned poet) used to defend the Messenger of Allah (with his poems). The Messenger of Allah jg said, «iiLJ jp 7J Lj L5 f, Jbl , jlll «0 Allah! Aid Hassan with Riih Al-Qudus, for he defended Your Prophet.^3! Abu Dawud recorded this Hadith in his Simon¹⁴ ' as did At- Tirmidhi who graded it Hasan Sahih. j5 ' Further, Ibn Hibban recorded in his Sahih that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Prophet said, 'I ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :269 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:270. 131 Fath Al-Bdri 10:562. Abu Dfiwud 5:279. 151 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:137.

Ir-** '-.T''' IP J-Asll £JJ jJ 'Z J « " «_jiyi^ <j)i i jZ\i uRuli Al-Qudus informed me that no soul shall die until it finishes its set provisions and term limit. Therefore, have Taqod of Allah and seek your sustenance in the most suitable way. 1] The Jews tried to kill the Prophet #, Az-Zamakhshari commented on Allah's statement, iSome you disbelieved and some you kill}, "Allah did not say 'killed' here, because the Jews would still try to kill the Prophet in the future, using poison and magic." During the illness that preceded his death, the Prophet jg said. jlj l jgij jL>- «isi kiJlj U «/ kept feeling the effect of what I ate (from the poisoned sheep) during the day of Kilmoubar, until now, when it is the time that the aorta will be cut off (meaning when death is near) fo2^ This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari and others.³ ' i88. And they say, "Our hearts are Ghulf." Nay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so little is that which they believe.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4h& ejs \}6j} 4And they say, "Our hearts are Ghulf."}, means, "Our hearts are screened." * Mujahid also said that, 4ht \}&j} ''' See As-Sunnah 14 :304 ,2* Ibn 'Adi 3:1239. '3 * Path Al-Bari 7 :737 141 At-Tabari 2 :326

dSQ Tafsir Ibn Kathir iAtid they say, "Our hearts are Ghulf."}, means, "They are covered." Ikrimah said, "There is a stamp on them."¹² ' Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "They do not comprehend."³ ' Mujahid and Qatadah said that Ibn 'Abbas read the Ayah in a way that means, "Our hearts contain every type of knowledge and do not need the knowledge that you (O Muhammad) have."⁴ ' This is the opinion of 'Ata' and Ibn 'Abbas. 4Nay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief» meaning, "Allah expelled them and deprived them of every type of righteousness." Qatadah said that the Ayah, iSo little is that which they believe.}' means, "Only a few of them believe."⁵ ' Allah's statement, ib& vj iAtid they say, "Our hearts are Ghidf."} is similar to His statement, XS, iAtid they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened) from that to which you invite us} (41:5). This is why Allah said here, iNay, Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so little is that which they believe.} meaning, "It is not as they claim. Rather, their hearts are cursed and stamped," just as Allah said in Surat An-Nisa' (4:155), 111 Ibid. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :274. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 273. ' Al-Qurtubi. 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :274.

292 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iAtid of their saying : "Our hearts are wrapped (with coverings, i.e. we do not understand what the Messengers say)" - nay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief, so they believe not but a little.} There is a difference of opinion regarding the meaning of Allah's statement, 4So little is that which they believe.} and His statement, &£ %} 4So they believe not except a feiv}. Some scholars said that the Ayat indicate that a few of them would believe, or that their faith is minute, because they believe in Resurrection and in Allah's reward and punishment that Musa foretold. Yet, this faith will not benefit them since it is overshadowed by their disbelief in what Muhammad jg brought them. Some scholars said that the Jews did not actually believe in anything and that Allah said, 4&S e ij&} 4So little is that which they believe}, meaning, they do not believe. This meaning is similar to the Arabic expression, "Hardly have I seen anything like this," meaning, "I have never seen anything like this." itjfo <_£ oyuilJ J-3 ^4 \yij HJ *x\ JCt oi 4 -a-* l ^ llii ijJiS 4S9. And when there came to them (the }eiv\$), a Book (this Qur'an) from Allah confirming what is with them (the Taivrdrh) and the Injil (Gospel), although aforetime they had invoked Allah (for the coming of Muhammad jfe) in order to gain victory over those who disbelieved, then when there came to them that which they had recognised, they disbelieved in it. So let the curse of Allah be on the disbelievers.} The Jewswere awaiting the Prophet's coming, but They disbelieved in Him when He was sent Allah said,

292 Tafsir Ibti Kathir J \ t (3JJI3! 4lw»la*j^i 'j)JtL^=y 't^jsAjk Jjil t£->\jjkd=uol |> j—a't \z*j LiCil ^ ^^ ^4i(Jljil lljo * -" / i ^ La-J(^*y J_yi LfcJ ^Jj-Sljij , -r> ••;<• aU-JLaJ »l>«gjjju^ ; -f-i .- \{if fy-i*fi<' ,< ,".^< < \ ' "i • s- L)-4-* - ijj ts££ll* I j^X^y^=^vx> ifejSjJjjjtj »IzA), 4l***t Qj^ 4And when there came to them^ meaning, the Jews, 4i^^ Si 4« Book from Allah} meaning, the Qur'an that Allah sent down to Muhammad, Uj 4confirming what is with them} meaning, the Tawrah. Further, Allah said, j? *m i\& sj ialthough aforetime they had invoked Allah (for coming of Muhammad 5fe) in order to gain victory over those who disbelieved} meaning, before this Messenger came to them, they used to ask Allah to aid them by his arrival, against their polytheistic enemies in war. They used to say to the polytheists, "A Prophet shall be sent just before the end of this world and we, along with him, shall exterminate you, just as the nations of 'Ad and Iram were exterminated." Also, Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Jews used to invoke Allah (for the coming of Muhammad jg) in order to gain victory over the Aws and Khazraj, before the Prophet was sent. When Allah sent him to the Arabs, they rejected him and denied what they used to say about him. Hence, Mu'adh bin Jabal and Bishr bin Al-Bara' bin Ma'rur, from Bani Salamah, said to them, 'O Jews! Fear Allah and embrace Islam. You used to invoke Allah for the coming of Muhammad when we were still disbelievers and you used to tell us that he would come

293 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) and describe him to us,' Salam bin Mushkim from Bani An- Nadlr replied, 'He did not bring anything that we recognize. He is not the Prophet we told you about.' Allah then revealed this Ayah about their statement, q && \$And ivhen there came to them (the Jews), a Book (this Qur'an) from Allah confirming what is with them (the Tawrdh) and the Injit (Gospel)} Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "The Jews used to ask Allah to send Muhammad jg so that they would gain victory over the Arab disbelievers. They used to say, 'O Allah! Send the Prophet that we read about - in the Tawrah - so that we can torment and kill the disbelievers alongside him.' When Allah sent Muhammad jg and they saw that he was not one of them, they rejected him and envied the Arabs, even

though they knew that he was the Messenger of Allah. Hence, Allah said, Jo Jill ilJji **_> >jy»i==» 'jjlfc l5 tU»^> iThen when there came to them that which they had recognized, they disbelieved in it. So let the curse of Allah be on the disbelievers}.”^ -4^3 J* at jl lli; iit JjJ IjyjtAso J p |.Jl'A \^S>} 490. How bad is i/iaf/or which they have sold their own selves, that they should disbelieve in that which Allah has revealed (the Qur'an), grudging that Allah should reveal of His grace unto whom He wills of His servants. So they have drawn on themselves wrath upon wrath. And for the disbelievers, there is disgracing torment.} Mujahid said, 4How bad is that for which they have sold their own selves}, “The 111 At-Tabari 2:333. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 276.

Jews sold the truth for falsehood and hid the truth about Muhammad sg.”1 ' 1 As-Suddi said that the Ayah, i^\ ijXif l£2L> iHoiv bad is thatfor which they have sold their mon selves} means, “The Jews sold themselves.”* * meaning, what is worse is what they chose for themselves by disbelieving in what Allah revealed to Muhammad jg instead of believing, aiding and supporting him. This behavior of theirs is the result of their injustice, envy and hatred, igmdging that Allah should reveal of His grace unto whom He ivills ofHis servants}.” There is no envy worse than this. Therefore, iLZk£ ijJu.ym 4So they have drawn on themselves wrath upon wrath}. Ibn ‘Abbas commented on this Ayah, “Allah became angry with them because they ignored some of the Tawrah and disbelieved in the Prophet that He sent to them.”131 I (Ibn Kathir) say that the meaning of, }And they drew on themselves} is that they deserved and acquired multiplied anger. Also, Abu Al-‘Aliyah said, “Allah became angry with them, because of their disbelief in the Injll and Isa and He became angry with them again, because they disbelieved in Muhammad sg and the Qur’an.”14 * Similar was said by ‘Ikrimah and Qatadah.15 * Allah said, 4And for the disbelievers, there is disgracing torment}. Since their disbelief was a result of their transgression and envy, which was caused by arrogance, they were punished with disgrace At-Jabari 2:340. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :277. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :279 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :278 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 279

and humiliation in this world and the Hereafter. Similarly, Allah said, 4 Verily , those toho scorn My worship (i.e. do not invoke Me, and do not believe in My Oneness) they will surely enter Hell in humiliation/”> (40:60) meaning, “Disgraced, degraded and humiliated.” Imam Ahmad narrated that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb said that his father said that his grandfather said that the Prophet 0& said, •jt JjaZ-j jllVl jlj ^A^aj (_r _jj . d Jli 1 ^ •jUl JaI ;jtu2P JlpJl «Ll» “77ie arrogant people will be gathered on the Day of Resurrection in the size of ants, but in the shape of men. Everything shall be above them, because of the humiliation placed on them, until they enter a prison in Jahannam called ‘Baiulas’ where the fire will surround them from above. They shall drinkfrom the puss of the people of the Fire.® jhj f*[fj Uj V.. jb Cj jjlli ill' Jrf t*J j-i 4i3 |*Mj •t*-j“ Si p will ll! 491. And when it is said to them (the Jews), "Believe in ivhat Allah has sent down," they say, "\Ne believe in what was sent doton to us." And they disbelieve in that which came after it, while it is the truth confirming what is with them. Say (O Muhammad % to them): "Why then have you killed the Prophets of Allah aforetime, if uou indeed have been believers? <92 . And indeed Musa came to you with clear proofs, yet you worshipped the calafter he left, and you were Zdlimun.) I 1 * Ahmad 2 :179.

^ Tafstr Ibn Kathtr Although The Jews denied the Truth, They claimed to be Believers! Allah said, iAnd when it is said to them}, meaning, the Jews and the People ofthe Book, 'Sj\ TL iBelieve in what Allah

has sent down to Muhammad \$fe, believe in and follow him, itS jj il^ \)&} iThey say, "We believe in what was sent down to us."4 meaning, it is enough for us to believe in what was revealed to us in the Tawrah and the Injll, and this is the path that we choose, iffij £>i&>j>} iAnd they disbelieve in that which came after it}. ifaci<&&\%} iwhile it is the truth confirming what is with them} meaning, while knowing that what was revealed to Muhammad jg, i'S 4it is the truth confirming what is with them}. This means that since what was sent to Muhammad jg conforms to what was revealed to the People of the Book, then this fact constitutes a proofagainst them. Similarly, Allah said, 4(***li? af&} iThose to whom We gave the Scripture (Jews and Christians) recognize him (Muhammad as they recognize their sons} (2:146). Allah said next. i^ji 4 J5 *\$ 'oM £} 4"Why then have you killed the Prophets ofAllah aforetime, if you indeed have been believers?". This means, "If your claim that you believe in what was

297Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) revealed to you is true, then why did you kill the Prophets who came to you affirming the Tawrah's Law, although you knew they were true Prophets? You killed them simply out of transgression, stubbornness and injustice with Allah's Messengers. Therefore, you only follow your lusts, opinions and desires." Similarly, Allah said, &JS f'JSUpH a# LL pK(M) 41\$ it that whenever there came to you a Messenger with what you yourselves desired not, you grew arrogant? Some you disbelieved and some you killed. } Also, As-Suddi said, "In this Ayah, Allah chastised the People of the Book, ; V * '* -y f{ X > > *7. 'iv C)[Ji «*>> sLi' lli 4Say (O Muhammad 5g to them) : "Why then have you kilted the Prophets of Allah aforetime, if you indeed have been believers?"." pkzaifc. jjij} 4And indeed Musa came to you with clear proofs} meaning, with clear signs and clear proofs that he was the Messenger of Allah and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. The clear signs -or miracles- mentioned here are the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs, the blood, the staff and the hand. Musa's miracles also include parting the sea, shading the Jews with clouds, the manna and quails, the gushing stone, etc. 4&J\ p} 4yet you worshipped the calf} meaning, as a deity instead of Allah, during the time of Musa. Allah's statement, iafter he left} after Musa went to Mount Tur to speak to Allah. Similarly, Allah said, 4And the people of Musa made in his absence, out of their m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :281

ornaments, the image ofa calf (for worship). It had a sound (as if it was mooing)} (7:148). iatid you were Zdlimun meaning, you were unjust in this behavior of worshipping the calf, although you knew that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah. Similarly, Allah said, a J*r») Wj I i/ iAnd wheti they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they (repented and) said: "Ifour Lord have not mercy upon us andforgive us, we shall certainly be of the losers"} (7:149). IjJLj }yu t* ijxi. jylill dlijj tJo-t ij} pSSiL) i* J} ti*\$ 493. And (remember) when We took your covenant and We raised above you the Mount (saying), "Hold firmly to what We have given you and hear (Our Word)." They said, "We have heard and disobeyed." And their hearts absorbed (the worship of) the calf because of their disbelief. Say : "Worst indeed is that which yourfaith enjoins on you ifyou are believers."} The Jews rebel after Allah took Their Covenant and raised the Mountain above Their Heads Allah reminded the Jews of their errors, breaking His covenant, transgression and defiance, when He raised Mount Tur above them so that they would believe and agree to the terms of the covenant. Yet, they broke it soon afterwards, tiL- \j\\$} iThey said, "We have heard and disobeyed."} We have mentioned the Tafsir of this subject

before. ‘Abdur-Razzaq said that Ma'mar narrated that Qatadah said that, iAnd their hearts absorbed (the worship of) the calf} means, “They

299Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) absorbed its love, until its love resided in their hearts. ’^ 1| This is also the opinion of Abu Al-‘Aliyah and Ar-Rabl* bin Anas. 121 Allah’s statement, 4Say ; "Worst indeed is that which your faith enjoins on you if you are believers."} means, “Worse yet is the manner in which you behaved in the past and even now, disbelieving in Allah’s Ayat and defying the Prophets. You also disbelieved in Muhammad which is the worst of your deeds and the harshest sin that you committed. You disbelieved in the Final Messenger and the master of all Prophets and Messengers, the one who was sent to all mankind. How can you then claim that you believe, while committing the evil of breaking Allah’s covenant, disbelieving in Allah’s Ayat and worshipping the calf instead ofAllah?" <j', ojil ujU) jji j* Xt 0*/\$' j'oJ' 1 o! lii(j 'jr^i Jj &>, *£> \$ c, Jjt % \&\)£. & osvSit 494. Say to (them) : "If the abode of the Hereafter with Allah is indeed for you especially and not for others of mankind, then longfor death ifyou are truthful."} 495. But they will never long for it because ofwhat their hands have sent before them (i.e. what they have done). And Allah is Aware of the Zalimin .} 496. And verily, you will find them (the Jeios) the greediest of mankind for life and (even greedier) than those who ascribe partners to Allah . One of them toishes that he could be given a life of a thousand years. But the grant ofsuch life will not save him even a little from (due) punishment. And Allah is Seer of what they do.} 'Abdur-Razzaq 1:52. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :283

Calling the Jews to invoke Allah to destroy the Unjust Party Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah said to His Prophet j\SJ\ £& 01 \$} jji o* <i' ip Ol 4Sfly to (thetn) : "If the home of the Hereafter with Allah is indeed for you especially and not for others, of mankind, then long for death if you are truthful."} meaning, ‘Invoke Allah to bring death to the lying camp among the two (Muslims and Jews).’ The Jews declined this offer by the Messenger of Allah ste.” 1 ’ 1 c-»ii tLj IjJ tj: J}} iBut they will never long for it because of what their hands have sent before them (i.e. what lthey have done). And Allah is Aware of the Zdlimin (polytheists and wrongdoers).} meaning, “Since they know that they recognize you, and yet disbelieve in you.” Had they wished death that day, no Jew would have remained alive on the face of the earth. Moreover, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, jSL-j'juI <>• s. . / , i >/ . s \ m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :284.

301Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) iThen long for death means, “Invoke (Allah) for death.”! Also, ‘Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ikrimah said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, ii,p\ iThen long for death if you are truthful>, “Had the Jews invoked Allah for death, they would have perished. |21 Also, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded Said bin Jubayr saying that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Had the Jews asked for death, one of them would have choked on his own saliva.”!3 ! These statements have authentic chains of narration up to Ibn ‘Abbas. Further, Ibn Jarir said in his Tafsir, “We were told that the Prophet jg said, ofa ij ->Ui hjju^ i I 4)1 JjLj 'jjLc Had the Jews wishedfor death,, they would have died and seen their seats in the Fire. And, those who invoked such curse against Allah's Messenger would have found no families or property had they returned to their homes*. ”!4 ! Similar to this Ayah is Allah’s statement in Surat Al-Jumu'ah, 4 ojll j;US' CjJj & 4 1/^1 4 3* '!*Jc li!) £* iJ Msjili !% !b OjV? 4 /lit li. c£j)' Ojlrj 4:.|5;>j£s 4(Sfly (O Muhammad : "O i/om Jews! If you pretend that you arefriends ofAllah, to the exclusion of (all) other mankind, then long for death if you are truthfid."But they will never long for it (death),

because of what (deeds) their hands have sent before them! And Allah knows well the Zdlimin. Say (to At-Jabari 2:366. !2 ! Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :285. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :284 At-Tabari 2 :362

them): "Verily, the death from which you flee will surely meet you, then you will be sent back to (Allah) the Knower of the unseen and the seen, and He will tell you what you used to do."} (62:6-8). So they claimed that they are Allah's sons and loved ones and said, "Only those who are Christian or Jews shall enter Paradise." Therefore, they were called to invoke Allah to destroy the lying group, be it them or the Muslims. When the Jews declined, every one was sure of their wrong, for had they been sure of their claims, then they would have accepted the proposal. Their lies were thus exposed after they declined the offer to invoke the curse. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah jfe called a delegation of Najran's Christians to curse after he refuted them in a debate in which they demonstrated stubbornness and defiance. Allah said, at -iliC $\text{t}^* \text{juL } *_{_} > \text{j}^* \text{oIJJ JLj 'fC-A}$ iThen whoever disputes with you concerning him ('Isa) after (all this) knowledge that has come to you (i.e. 'Isa) being a servant of Allah, and having no share in divinity), say (O Muhammad jg) ; "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves - then we pray and invoke (sincerely) the curse of Allah upon those who lie/"} (3:61). When the Christians heard this challenge, some of them said to each other, "By Allah! If you do such with this Prophet, none of you will have an eye that blinks." This is when they resorted to peace and gave the Jizyah (tax) in disgrace. The Prophet jg accepted the Jizyah from them and sent Abu 'Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah with them as a trustee. Similar to this meaning is Allah's command to His Prophet gg to proclaim to the polytheists: iSay (O Muhammad jg) whoever is in error, the Most Gracious (Allah) will prolong him (in it).} (19:75) meaning, "Whoever among us has deviated, may Allah increase

303 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) and prolong his deviation." We will mention this subject later, Allah willing. The Mubalahah (invocation to Allah to destroy the liars) was called a 'wish' here, because every just person wishes that Allah destroy the unjust opponent who is debating with him, especially when the just person has a clear, apparent proof for the truth he is calling to. Also, the Mubalahah involves invoking Allah for death of the unjust group, because to disbelievers, life is the biggest prize, especially when they know the evil destination they will meet after death. Disbelievers wish They could live longer This is why Allah said next, iBut they will never long for it because of what their hands have sent before them (i.e.what they have done). And Allah is Aware of the Zdlimin. And verily, you will find that (the jews) the greediest of mankind for life meaning, greedy to live longer, because they know their evil end, and the only reward they will have with Allah is total loss. This life is a prison for the believer and Paradise for the disbeliever. Therefore, the People of the Book wish they could delay the Hereafter, as much as possible. However, they shall certainly meet what they are trying to avoid, even if they are more eager to delay the Hereafter than the polytheists who do not have a divine book. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Ibn 'Abbas commented on, 4[^]-4 £ St 4 But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from (due) punishment. \$ "Long life shall not save them from torment. Certainly, the polytheists do not believe in resurrection after death, and they would love to enjoy a long life. The Jews know the humiliation they will suffer in the Hereafter for knowingly ignoring the truth."111 Also, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "The Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :288.

Jews are most eager for this life. They wish they could live for a thousand years. However, living for a thousand years will not save them from torment, just as Iblis' - Satan - long life did not benefit him, due to being a disbeliever." Lij 'aj} iAtid Allah is Seer of what they do.} meaning, "Allah knows what His servants are doing, whether good or evil, and will compensate each of them accordingly." Aj-b L«j Li Jil jiU i!ti» Je (Jj J Ijgit & 'j-1* Cr* ,v 0!HS 497. Say (O Muhammad sg) : "Whoever is an enemy to Jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it (i.e. the Tawrdh and the Injil) and guidance and glad tidings for the believers}. 498. "Whoever is an enemy to Allah, His Angels, His Messengers, Jibril and Mikd'il, then verily, Allah is an enemy to the disbelievers."} The Jews are the Enemies of Jibril Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir At-Tabari said, "The scholars of Tafsir agree that this Ayah (2: 97-98) was revealed in response to the Jews who claimed that Jibril (Gabriel) is an enemy of the Jews and that Mika'il (Michael) is their friend." 121 Al-Bukhari said, "Allah said, iWhoever is an enemy of Jibril (let him die in his fury)}. 'Ikrimah said, "Jibr, Mik and Israfil all mean, worshipper, while Il means, Allah". Anas bin Malik said, "When 'Abdullah bin Salam heard of the arrival of the Prophet jg in Al-Madinah, he was working on his land. He came to the Prophet jg and said, I am going to ask you about three things which nobody knows except a 111 At-Tabari 2:376. 121 At-Tabari 2:377.

305 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - 100) (Part-1) Prophet. What will be the first portent of the Hour? What will be the first meal taken by the people of Paradise? Why does a child resemble its father, and why does it resemble its maternal uncle?' Allah's Messenger sg said, «Jibril has just told me the answers .» 'Abdullah said, *He (i.e. Jibril), among all the angels, is the enemy of the Jews.' Allah's Messenger sg recited the Ayah, 4Whoever is an enemy to jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart. Allah's Messenger jg then said, "The first portent of the Hour will be a fire that will bring together the people from the east to the west; the first meal of the people of Paradise will be the caudate lobe of the liver of fish. As for the child resembling his parents: If a man has sexual intercourse with his wife and his discharge is first, the child will resemble the father. If the woman has a discharge first, the child will resemble her side of the family .» On that 'Abdullah bin Salam said, I testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and you are the Messenger of Allah.' 'Abdullah bin Salam further said, 'O Allah's Messenger! The Jews are liars, and if they should come to know about my conversion to Islam before you ask them (about me), they will tell a lie about me.' The Jews came to Allah's Messenger fg, and 'Abdullah went inside the house. Allah's Messenger jg asked (the Jews), ""What kind of man is 'Abdullah bin Salam?" They replied, 'He is the best among us, the son of the best among us, our master and the son of our master.' Allah's Messenger jg said, "What do you think if he would embrace Islam?" The Jews said, 'May Allah save him from it.' Then 'Abdullah bin Salam came out in front of them saying, 'I testify that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.' Thereupon they said, "He is the evilest among us, and the son of the evilest among us.' And they continued talking badly about him. Ibn Salam said, This is what I feared, O Messenger of Allah!." Only Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith with this chain of narration. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this Hadith from Anas using 111 Path Al-Bari 8:15& 7:319.

another chain of narration.' Some people say that 'il' means worshipper while whatever word that is added to it becomes Allah's Name, because 'Il' is a constant in such conjunction. This is similar to the

names ‘Abdullah, ‘Abdur-Rahman, ‘Abdul-Malik, ‘Abdul-Quddus, ‘Abdus-Salam, ‘Abdul-Kafi, ‘Abdul-Jalil, and so forth. Hence, ‘Abd’ is constant in these compound names, while the remainder differs from name to name. This is the same case with Jibril, Mika11, ‘Azrall, Israfil, and so forth. Allah knows best. Choosing Some Angels to believe in over Others is Disbelieflike choosingSome Prophets over Others Allah said. [^]fil\ JU» Jc jjy /Cji C& [^]Whoever is an enemy to fibril (Gabriel) (lei him die in his fury), far indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, meaning, whoever becomes an enemy of Jibril, let him know that he is Ruh Al-Qudus who brought down the Glorious Dhikr (Qur'an) to your heart from Allah by His leave. Hence, he is a messenger from Allah. Whoever takes a messenger as an enemy, will have taken all the messengers as enemies. Further, whoever believes in one messenger, is required to believe in all of the messengers. Whoever rejects one messenger, he has rejected all of the messengers. Similarly, Allah said, oty ‘4-JJ MS' [jV? o' >MMJ -ijj jit / * * * - [^]Verily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers and wish to make distinction between Allalt and His Messengers (by believing in Allah and disbelieving in His Messengers) saying, "We believe in some but reject others/> (4:150) Allah decreed that they are disbelievers, because they believe in some Prophets and reject others. This is the same |i| Sahih Al-Bukhari3329, 3911, 3938, and Muslim 315.

307Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (75 - WO) (Part-1 with those who take Jibril as an enemy, because Jibril did not choose missions on his own, but by the command of his Lord, iAnd we (angels) descend not except by the command of your Lord> (19:64), and, iAnd truly, this (the Qur'an) is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists. Which the trustivorthy Riith (Jibril) has brought doivn. Upon your heart (O Muhammad jg) that you may be (one) of the wamers} (26:192-194). Al-Bukhari reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, iai LJj [^]3 y #Allah said, 'Whoever takes a friend ofMine as an enemy, tvill have started a war with Mt'J Therefore, Allah became angry with those who took Jibril as an enemy. Allah said, Ci Ui-ii jib Jiii 'f,j /du JpJwJ 'jj* ifo} iWhocver is an enemy to Jibril (Gabriel) (let him die in his fury), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it} meaning, the previous Books, * 'V' iand guidance and glad tidings for the believers meaning, as guidance to their hearts and bringer of the good news of Paradise, which is exclusively for the believers. Similarly, Allah said, iSay : "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing."} (41:44), and, 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :348

309Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 and earth and Knower of the seen and the unseen! You judge between Your servants regarding what they differ in, so direct me to the truth which they differ on, by Your leave. Verily, You guide whom You will to the straight path. Allah's statement, itthen verily, Allalt is an enemy to the disbelievers} informed the disbelievers that whoever takes a friend of Allah as an enemy, then he has taken Allah as an enemy, and whoever treats Allah as an enemy, then he shall be Allah's enemy. Indeed, whoever is an enemy of Allah then he will lose in this life and the Hereafter, as stated earlier; Jii J jSli- «Whoever takes a friend ofMine as an enemy, I shall wage war on &m [^]v\$8 & J44 & »S£ iTjj i(-S £& 12 t£Za 5[^]2 &5j ujZ& \$ ijLdii ijS2 c v Uj Jp- jjji tj o-Uif Ojli oJyjjj l* l* 4*5 /i cji ij£- Ujl jji CjULtf jp*i*j *i' jib -a, [^]bj »P' jib [^]ij£2 u *1* iU-yi a Ji u cp' ipti Jaij ‘,4iib IJjSJ; \pa j) 4£:<[^]Lz \}t 499. And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Ayat and none disbelieve in them but Fdsiqun (those who rebel against Allah's command).} 4100. Is it not (the case) that every time they make a covenant, some 111 Muslim 1 :534 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :348.

320 Tafstr Ibn Kathir party among them throw it aside? Nay! (the truth is :) most of them believe not.} 4202. And when there came to them a Messenger from Allah (i.e. Muhammad confirming what was with them, a party of those who were given the Scripture threw away the Book of Allah behind their backs as if they did not know!) 4202. They followed what the Shaydtn (devils) gave out (falsely of the magic) in the lifetime of Sulayman (Solomon). Sulayman did not disbelieve, but the Shaydtn (devils) disbelieved teaching men magic and such things that came down at Babylon to the two angels, Hdriit and Mdrut, but neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us)." And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife, but they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave. And they learn that which harms them and profits them not. And indeed they knew that the buyers of it (magic) would have no share in the Hereafter. And how bad indeed was that for which they sold their own selves, if they but knew.} 4103. And if they had believed and guarded themselves from evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord, if they but knew!} maA u m» <La^=uLJ \ JljAUj [/ECSpijb Cjt CiyXtCjJ -'i' \pc 'jlfijtXX'j i ydAi \ jiLjt \yXXj\ifX>\ - - '< •• £ *• >A <01'j J^O'

311 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Proofs of Muhammad's Prophethood Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir said that Allah's statement, g W i And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Ayafy means, "We have sent to you, O Muhammad, clear signs that testify to your prophethood." These Ayat are contained in the Book of Allah (Qur'an) which narrates the secrets of the knowledge that the Jews possess, which they hid, and the stories of their earlier generations. The Book of Allah also mentions the texts in the Books of the Jews that are known to only the rabbis and scholars, and the sections where they altered and distorted the rulings of the Tawrah. Since Allah mentioned all of this in His Book revealed to His Prophet Muhammad jg, then this fact alone should be enough evidence for those who are truthful with themselves and who wish to avoid bringing themselves to destruction due to envy and transgression. Further human instinct testifies to the truth that Muhammad sg was sent with and the clear signs that he brought which he did not learn or acquire from mankind. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4^ . p.i W i And indeed We have sent down to you manifest Aydfy means, "You recite and convey this Book to them day and night, although you are an Ummi (unlettered) who never read a book. Yet, you inform them of what they have (in their own Books). Allah stated that this fact should serve as an example, a clear sign and a proof against them, if they but knew." The Jews break Their Covenants When the Messenger of Allah sg was sent and Allah reminded the Jews of the covenant that they had with Him, especially concerning Muhammad jg, Malik bin As-Sayf said, "By Allah! Allah never made a covenant with us about Muhammad, nor did He take a pledge from us at all." Allah then revealed, m At-Tabari 2 :397

41s it not (the case) that every time they make a covenant, some party among them throw it aside?} li] Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that Allah's statement, iNay! (the truth is :) most of them believe not means, "There is not a promise that they make, but they break it and abandon it. They make a promise today and break it tomorrow." 121 The Jews abandoned the Book of Allah and practiced Magic As-Suddi commented on, a, 3^2 if Si 4 And when there came to them a Messenger from Allah (i.e. Muhammad confirming what was with them) "When Muhammad jg came to them, they wanted to contradict and dispute with him using the Tawrah. However, the Tawrah and the Qur'an affirmed each other. So the

Jews gave up on using the Torah, and took to the Book of Asaf,¹³ and the magic of Harut and Marut, which indeed did not conform to the Qur'an. Hence Allah's statement, 'As if they did not know!'.⁴¹ Also, Qatadah said that Allah's statement, 'As if they did not know' means, "They knew the truth but abandoned it, hid it and denied the fact that they even had it."⁵ At-Tabari 2 :400 > Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :295. ^ Lisan Al-Arab lists Asaf as the name of the Book revealed to the Prophet Sulayman, peace be upon him. See also the explanation that follows ^ At-Tabari 2 :404 |s| Ibid.

323 Surah 2. Al-Baarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 Magic existed before Sulayman (Solomon) As-Suddi said that Allah's statement, 'They knew what the Shayatin (devils) gave out (falsely of the magic) in the lifetime of Sulayman' means, "During the time of Prophet Solomon.' Beforehand, the devils used to ascend to heaven and eavesdrop on the conversations of the angels about what will occur on the earth

regarding death, other incidents or unseen matters. They

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 313–335]

would convey this news to the soothsayers, and the soothsayers would in turn convey the news to the people. The people would believe what the soothsayers told them as being true. When the soothsayers trusted the devils, the devils started to lie to them and added other words to the true news that they heard, to the extent of adding seventy false words to each true word. The people recorded these words in some books. Soon after, the Children of Israel said that the Jinns know matters of the Unseen. When Solomon was sent as a Prophet, he collected these books in a box and buried it under his throne; any devil that dared get near the box was burned. Solomon said, 'I will not hear of anyone who says that the devils know the Unseen, but I will cut off his head.' When Solomon died and the scholars who knew the truth about Solomon perished, there came another generation. To them, the devil materialized in the shape of a human and said to some of the Children of Israel, 'Should I lead you to a treasure that you will never be able to use up?' They said. "Yes.' He said, 'Dig under this throne,' and he went with them and showed them Solomon's throne. They said to him, 'Come closer.' He said, 'No. I will wait for you here, and if you do not find the treasure then kill me.' They dug and found the buried books, and Satan said to them, 'Solomon only controlled the humans, devils and birds with this magic.' Thereafter, the news that Solomon was a sorcerer spread among the people, and the Children of Israel adopted these books. When Muhammad came, they disputed with him relying on these books. Hence Allah's statement, 'Laili Uj»

iSulayman did not disbelieve, but the Shayatin (devils) disbelieved}. The Story of Harut and Marut, and the Explanation that They were Angels Allah said, 'Uj ejiyyk JAi Jp J>' 4Awf swell filings that came down at Babylon to the two angels, Harut and Marut, but neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us)." And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife}. There is a difference of opinion regarding this story. It was said that this Ayah denies that anything was sent down to the two angels, as Al-Qurtubi stated and then referred to the Ayah, iSulayman did not disbelieve} saying, "The negation applies in both cases. Allah then said, '4cfe=dl)' Jc Jjli tj iBut the Shayatin (devils) disbelieved, teaching men magic and such things fluff came down at Babylon to the two angels}. The Jews claimed that Gabriel and Michael brought magic down to the two angels, but

Allah refuted this false claim.”*2 ' Also, Ibn Jarir reported, that Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, *Jt Jy\ Lj> i*And such things that came down at Babylon to the two angels} “Allah did not send magic down.”*3' Also, Ibn Jarir narrated that Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said about, 111 At-Tabari 2:405. * Al-Qurtubi 2 :50 •3| At-Tabari 2:419.

(> jiii tj)> si/c/i things that came down to the two angels>, “Allah did not send magic down to the them.”¹ 11 Ibn Janr commented, “This is the correct explanation for this Ayah. {They followed what the Shaydtn (devils) gave out (falsely) in the lifetime of Sulaymdn . \$ meaning, magic. However, neither did Solomon disbelieve nor did Allah send magic with the two angels. The devils, on the other hand, disbelieved and taught magic to the people of the Babylon of Harut and Marut.” Ibn Janr continued; “If someone asks about explaining this Ayah in this manner, we say that, vilii& iThey followed what the Sltaydtiti (devils) gave out (falsely) in the lifetime of Sulaymdn means, magic. Solomon neither disbelieved nor did Allah send magic with the two angels. However, the devils disbelieved and taught magic to the people in the Babylon of Harut and Marut, meaning Gabriel and Michael, for Jewish sorcerers claimed that Allah sent magic by the words of Gabriel and Michael to Solomon, son of David. Allah denied this false claim and stated to His Prophet Muhammad jg that Gabriel and Michael were not sent with magic. Allah also exonerated Solomon from practicing magic, which the devils taught to the people of Babylon by the hands of two men, Harut and Marut. Hence, Harut and Marut were two ordinary men (not angels or Gabriel or Michael).”¹²¹ These were the words of At-Tabari, and this explanation is not plausible. Many among the Salaf, said that Harut and Marut were angels who came down from heaven to earth and did what they did as the Ayah stated. To conform this opinion with the fact that the angels are immune from error, we say that Allah had eternal knowledge what these angels would do, just as He At-Tabari 2:419. ¹²¹ Ibid.

had eternal knowledge that Ibls would do as he did, while Allah referred to him being among the angels, 4And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves before Adam." And they prostrated except Ibls (Satan), he refused^ (20 :116) and so forth. However, what Harut and Marut did was less evil than what Ibls, may Allah curse him, did. Al-Qurtubi reported this opinion from 'Ali, Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn 'Umar, Ka*b Al-Ahbar, As-Suddi and Al-Kalbi. Learning Magic is Kufr Allah said, ^ Vi ilii (ft Cii Vyj aJ iBut neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us).} Abu Ja'far Ar-Razi said that Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said that Qays bin 'Abbad said that Ibn 'Abbas said, “When someone came to the angels to learn magic, they would discourage him and say to him, *We are only a test, so do not fall into disbelief.’ They had knowledge of what is good and evil and what constitutes belief or disbelief, and they thus knew that magic is a form of disbelief. When the person who came to learn magic still insisted on learning it, they commanded him to go to such and such place, where if he went, Satan would meet him and teach him magic. When this man would learn magic, the light (of faith) would depart him, and he would see it shining (and flying away) in the sky. He would then proclaim, “O my sorrow! Woe unto me! What should I do?.”*2 ' Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that this Ayah means, “The angels were sent with magic, so that the people whom Allah willed would be tried and tested. Allah made them promise that they would not teach anyone until first proclaiming, We are a test *** Al-Qurtubi 2 :51 ' Ibn AbiHfitim 1:312.

Surah 2, Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) 317 for you, do not fall into disbelief.' ”1 ' It was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Also, Qatadah said, “Allah took their covenant to not teach anyone magic until they said, We are a test. Therefore, do not fall in disbelief.”121 Also, As-Suddi said, “When a man would come to the two angels they would advise him, ‘Do not fall into disbelief. We are a test.’ When the man would ignore their advice, they would say, ‘Go to that pile of ashes and urinate on it.’ When he would urinate on the ashes, a light, meaning the light of faith, would depart from him and would shine until it entered heaven. Then something black that appeared to be smoke would descend and enter his ears and the rest of his body, and this is Allah’s anger. When he told the angels what happened, they would teach him magic. So Allah’s statement, iBut neither of these two (angels) taught anyone (such things) till they had said, "We are for trial, so disbelieve not (by learning this magic from us) ,^3 Sunayd said that Hajjaj said that Ibn Jurayj commented on this Ayah (2:102), “No one dares practice magic except a disbeliever. As for the Fitnah, it involves trials and freedom of choice.”14 ' The scholars who stated that learning magic is disbelief relied on this Ayah for evidence. They also mentioned the Hadlth that Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded from ‘Abdullah, which states, 1Whoever came to a soothsayer or a sorcerer and believed in what he said, will have disbelieved in what Allah revealed to Muhammad This Hadith has an authentic chain of narration and there are other Haddths which support it. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:310 At-Jabari 2 :443 At-Tabari 2:443. 141 Ibid. ,S| KashafAl-Astar 2 :443

Causing a Separation between the Spouses is One of the Effects of Magic Allah said, 4And from these (angels) people learn that by which they cause separation between man and his wife,} This means, “The people learned magic from Harut and Marut and indulged in evil acts that included separating spouses, even though spouses are close to, and intimately associate with each other. This is the devil’s work.” Muslim recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah % said, o-Ua oUl jl® . « i ' * * ' ”1*’ 5 ' . t . i " \ • * * ' \ t " S'*. » ' • • * >?. • f *c5 C-Jj Aili oJlP I <S'Jj U : f-^uj 4 llli U <i> I vj l ir~^ \ / * " * * A " >* > ' * > * , > ' i • j ' " * ' i z l pJU I (JjAjJ 4^jlbj AjjJbj VJ tAJ-Al ^jziJ aSatan erects his throne on water and sends his emissaries among the people. The closest person to him is the person who causes the most Fitnah . One of them (a devil) would come to him and woidd say, 7 kept inciting so-and-so, until he said such and such ivords.' Iblfs says, 'No, by Allah, you have not done much.' Another devil would come to him and would say, 7 kept inciting so-and-so, until I separated betioeen him and his wife.' Satan would draw him closer and embrace him, saying, 'Yes, you did well .'s 1 ' 1 Separation between a man and his wife occurs here because each spouse imagines that the other spouse is ugly or ill- mannered, etc. Allah’s AppointedTerm supercedes Everything Allah said, jib 7; £3 ij pi uj^ m Muslim 4 :2167

319 Surah 2. Al-Baaarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) iBut they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave}. Sufyan Ath-Thawri commented, “Except by Allah’s appointed term.” Further, Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that, ‘ii, iBut they could not thus harm anyone except by Allah's leave means, “Allah allows magicians to adversely affect whomever He wills and saves whomever He wills from them. Sorcerers never bring harm to anyone except by Allah’s leave.”*21 Allah’s statement, 4*^ . ^ £ ofrzmj^ 4And they learn that which harms them and profits them not.} means, it harms their religion and does not have a benefit compared to its harm. && 4 \$ ^ SJdj} 4And indeed they knew that the buyers of it (magic) would have no (Khalaq) share in the Hereafter.} meaning, “The Jews who preferred magic over following the Messenger of Allah knew that those who commit the same error shall have no Khalaq in

the Hereafter.” Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and As-Suddi stated that ‘no Khalaq’ means, *no share.’³ Allah then said, ⁴And hmo bad indeed was that for which they sold their own selves, if they but kneiv. And if they had believed and guarded themselves from evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord, if they but knew!}. Allah stated, ⁴And hoxv bad} meaning, what they preferred, magic, instead of faith and following the Messenger, if they but comprehend the * ! * Ibn Abi Hatim 1:312. Ibn Abi Hatim 1:311. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :314.

advice. ⁴jf*~ jSj^ 4A«d if they had believed and guarded thetnselvesfrom evil and kept their duty to Allah, far better would have been the reward from their Lord,} meaning, “Had they believed in Allah and His Messenger aS and avoided the prohibitions, then Allah’s reward for these good deeds would have been better for them than what they chose and preferred for themselves.” Similarly, Allah said, ' j*. <jil L>y i \yf Jfij} 4> 'il iBut those who had been given (religious) knowledge said: 'Woe to you! The reward of Allah (in the Hereafter) is better for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and this none shall attain except As-Sabirun (the patient in following the truth)."} (28:80). oi^ % d %^4 ji ii'j *t£S if liif} if yt- 4104. O you who believe! Say not (to the Messenger s&j Raind but say Unzumd (make us understand) and hear. And for tlte disbelievers there is a painful torment.} 4105. Neither those who disbelieve among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) nor Al-Mushrikin (the idolaters) like that there should be sent down unto you any good from your Lord. But Allah chooses for His mercy whom He wills. And Allah is the Owner ofgreat bounty.} Manners in Speech Allah forbade His believing servants from imitating the behavior and deeds of the disbelievers. The Jews used to use devious words that hide what they really meant. May Allah’s curse be upon them. When they wanted to say, ‘hear us,’ they would use the word Rd‘ind, which is an insult (in Hebrew, but means ‘hear us’ in Arabic). Allah said,

- Jf- 'cxCae.j L-Lt- jf. 'jji* Cjjl' 'jji- jSCJ (Uilj ILL\$- ljS£ jij ^ ulLj CJ ^ 18& iAmong those who are Jews, there are some who displace words from (their) right places and sap: "We hear your word (O Muhammad j£j and disobey," and "Hear and let you (O Muhammad %g) hear nothing." And Rd'ind with a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion (Islam). And if only they had said: "We hear and obey," and "Do make us understand," it would have been better for them, and more proper; but Allah cursed them for tlteir disbelief, so they believe not except a feiv\$ (4:46). Also, the Hadiths stated that when they would greet Muslims, they would say, ‘As-Samu ‘alaykum,’ meaning, ‘death be to you’. This is why we were commanded to answer them by saying, ‘Wa ‘alaykum,’ meaning, ‘and to you too’, then our supplication against them shall be answered, rather than theirs against us. Allah forbade the believers from imitating the disbelievers in tongue or deed. Allah said, 'i \p\ : /j!' iO you who believe! Say not (to the Messenger Rd'ind but say Unzurnd (make us understand) and hear. And for the disbelievers there is a painful torment (2:104). Also, Imam Ahmad narrated that Ibn ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sB said, vlb^i 't lli-j v_4ll3L ii-lUl CUjI *—1Ute- jU .illj aJLSI «/ was sent with the sword just before the Last Hour, so that Allah is worshipped alone without partners. My sustenance was providedfor mefrom under the shadow ofmy spear. Those who oppose my command were humiliated and made inferior, and

322 Tafeir Ibn Kathir whoever imitates a people, he is one of //lem. Abu Dawud narrated that the Prophet jg said, J*' «Whoever imitates a people is one of them. These Hadiths indicate, along with their

threats and warnings, that we are not allowed to imitate the disbelievers in their statements, deeds, clothes, feasts, acts of worship, etc., whatever actions of the disbelievers that were not legislated for us. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, 4 Say not (to the Messenger j||) Ra’ina} “They used to say to the Prophet jg, Ar’ina samak (which is an insult).”³ * Ibn Abu Hatim said that it was reported that Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Abu Malik, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi and Qatadah said similarly. Further, Mujahid said, “T>o not say Ra’ina’ means, ‘Do not dispute’.”¹⁵¹ Mujahid said in another narration, “Do not say, *We hear from you, and you hear from us.” Also, ‘Ata’ said, “Do not say, iRa’ina}, which was a dialect that the Ansar used and which was forbidden from use by Allah.”¹⁶ Also, As-Suddi said, “Rifa’ah bin Zayd, a Jewish man from the tribe of Qaynuqa*, used to come to the Prophet and say to him, ‘Hear, Ghayr Musma’in (let you hear nothing).’ The Muslims used to think that the Prophets are greeted and honored with this type of speech, and this is why some of them used to say, ‘Hear, let you hear nothing,’ and so on, as mentioned in Surat An-Nisa.” Thereafter, Allah forbade the believers from uttering the word Ra’ina.”⁷ ‘Abdur-Rahman bin (I * Ahmad 2:50. * Abu Dawud 4 :314. * At-Tabari 2 :461 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :317. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :318. * Ibid. * At-Tabari 2:462.

323 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Zayd bin Aslam also said similarly. The extreme Enmity that the Disbelievers and the People of the Book have against Muslims Allah said next (2:105), if /~ if Sjs J <4^ ^ v Si ^ M> iNeither those who disbelieve among the People of the Scripture (Jeu>s and Christians) nor Al-Mushrikfn (the idolaters), like that there should be sent down unto you any good from your Lord}. Allah described the deep enmity that the disbelieving polytheists and People of the Scripture, whom Allah warned against imitating, have against the believers, so that Muslims should sever all friendship with them. Also, Allah mentioned what He granted the believers of the perfect Law that He legislated for their Prophet Muhammad jg. Allah said, iBut Allah chooses for His mercy whom He wills. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty^ (2:105). t,L ofe '.4.-1 : jl ol. jwj C tlj if\$ if Lj ojuVlj lilii \$ iit fui jiii J/ji 4106. Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh (We abrogate) or Nunsihd (cause to be forgotten), We bring a better one or similar to it. Kncnv you not that Allah is Able to do all things?} 4W7. Know you not that it is Allah to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth? And besides Allah you have neither any Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper.} The Meaning of Naskh Ibn Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, [i] Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :965

bt £-* 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, “Whatever an Ayah We abrogate.” Also, Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that, ^#5* bt ^ 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh> means, “Whatever an Ayah We erase. Also, Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that, b\ 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, “We keep the words, but change the meaning.” He related these words to the companions of ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud.¹³¹ Ibn Abi Hatim said that similar statements were mentioned by Abu Al-‘Aliyah and Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi.⁴ ’ Also As-Suddi said that, bi ^ iWhatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh} means, “We erase it.”⁵¹ Further, Ibn Abi Hatim said that it means, “Erase and 111 At-Tabari 2 :473 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:321. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :322. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :322 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :322. at bt \bj l) y’1^1 1liiii » *> s*s ' > * ,<.t-s <s / - / •><{•• A" *X<

325 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) raise it, such as erasing the following wordings (from the Qur’an), The married adulterer and the married adulteress: stone them to death,’ and, *If the son

of Adam had two valleys of gold, he would seek a third.' " Ibn Jarir stated that, 4#5* hi ^ ^Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh) means, "Whatever ruling we repeal in an Ayah by making the allowed unlawful and the unlawful allowed." The Nasakh only occurs with commandments, prohibitions, permissions, and so forth. As for stories, they do not undergo Nasakh. The word, *Nasakh' literally means, "to copy a book'. The meaning of Nasakh in the case of commandments is removing the commandment and replacing it by another. And whether the Nasakh involves the wordings, the ruling or both, it is still called Nasakh. Allah said next, ior Nunsuha (cause it to be forgotten)). *Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said that, *4^ &'» hi 4Whatever a verse (revelation) do Nansakh or Nunsuha) means, "Whatever Ayah We repeal or uphold without change."*3 * Also, Mujahid said that the companions of Ibn Mas*Qd (who read this word Nansa'ha) said that it means, "We uphold its wording and change its ruling."*4 * Further, *Ubayd bin TJmayr, Mujahid and 'Ata' said, 'Nansa'ha.' means, "We delay it (i.e., do not abrogate it)." * Further, 'Atiyyah Al-'Awfi said that the Ayah means, "We delay repealing it." * This is the same Tafsir provided by As- Suddi and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas.*7 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :324. * At-Tabari 1 :472 * At-Tabari 2:476. * At-Tabari 2:473. * At-Tabari 2:477. * Ibid. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :326

327Siirah 2. Al-Bacjarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper Allah directed His servants to the fact that He alone is the Owner of His creatures and that He does with them as He wills. Indeed, His is the supreme authority and all creation is His, and just as He created them as He wills, He brings happiness to whom He wills, misery to whom He wills, health to whom He wills and ailment to whom He wills. He also brings success to whom He wills and failure to whom He wills. He judges between His servants as He wills, allows what He wills and disallows what He wills. He decides what He wills, there is no opponent for His judgment, and no one can question Him about what He does, while they shall be questioned. He tests His servants and their obedience to His Messengers by the Naskh. He commands a matter containing a benefit which He knows of, and then He out of His wisdom, prohibits it. Hence, perfect obedience is realized by adhering to His commands, following His Messengers, believing in what ever they convey, implementing their commands and avoiding what they prohibit. The statements of Allah here contain tremendous benefit, prove that the Jews are disbelievers and refute their claim that Naskh does not occur, may Allah curse the Jews. In ignorance and arrogance they claimed that the sound mind stipulates that Naskh does not occur. Some of them falsely claimed that there are divine texts that dismiss the possibility that Naskh occurred. Imam Abu JaTar bin Jarir said, "The Ayah means, 'Do you not know, O Muhammad, that I alone own the heavens and the earth and that I decide whatever I will in them? I forbid whatever I will, change and repeal whatever I will of My previous rulings, whenever I will. I also uphold whatever I will.'" Ibn Jarir then said, "Although Allah directed His statement indicating His greatness towards His Prophet zg,, He also rejected the lies of the Jews who denied that the rulings of the Torah could undergo Naskh. The Jews also denied the prophethood of Jesus and Muhammad, because of their dislike for what they brought from Allah, such as changing some rulings of the Torah, as Allah commanded. Allah thus proclaimed to the Jews that He owns the heavens and earth

328 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir and also all authority in them. Further, the subjects in Allah's kingdom are His creation, and they are required to hear and obey His commands and prohibitions. Allah has full authority to command the creation as He wills, forbidding them from what He wills, abrogate what He

wills, uphold what He wills, and decide whatever commandments and prohibitions He wills.”¹¹¹ Ibn Kathir) say that the Jews’ dismissal of the occurrence of the Naskh is only a case of their disbelief and rebellion. The sound mind does not deny that there could be a Naskh in Allah’s commandments, for He decides what He wills, just as He does what He wills. Further, Naskh occurred in previous Books and Law. For instance, Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons and then later forbade this practice. Allah also allowed Nuh to eat from all kinds of animals after they left the ark, then prohibited eating some types of foods. Further, marrying two sisters to one man was allowed for Israel and his children, but Allah prohibited this practice later in the Torah. Allah commanded Abraham to slaughter his son, then repealed that command before it was implemented. Also, Allah commanded the Children of Israel to kill those who worshipped the calf and then repealed that command, so that the Children of Israel were not all exterminated. There are many other instances that the Jews admit have occurred, yet they ignore them. Also, it is a well-known fact that their Books foretold about Muhammad ﷺ and contained the command to follow him. These texts, in their Books, indicate that the Jews were required to follow the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and that no good deed would be accepted from them, unless it conformed to Muhammad’s Law. The Prophet ﷺ brought another Book, - the Qur’an -, which is the last revelation from Allah. s X4 at i3~' (S 3 Oil 4108. Or do you want to ask your Messenger (Muhammad as Musa (Moses) was asked before (i.e. show us openly our Lord)? And he who changes faith for disbelief, verily, he has At-Tabari 2 :488

gone astray from the right way.} The Prohibition of Unnecessary Questions In this Ayah, Allah forbade the believers from asking the Prophet ﷺ numerous questions about matters that did not occur yet. Similarly, Allah said, Iji 4 j], £ i£3 v \p: ip4^ iO you who believe! Ask not about things which, if made plain to you, may cause you trouble. But if you ask about them while the Qur’an is being revealed, they will be made plain to you} (5:101). This Ayah means, “If you ask about a matter after it is revealed, it shall be duly explained to you. Therefore, do not ask about matters that have not occurred yet, for they might become prohibited, due to your questions.” This is why the Sahah narrated. “The greatest criminal among the Muslims is the one who asks if a thing is prohibited, which is not prohibited, and it becomes prohibited because of his asking about it.” This is why when the Messenger of Allah was asked about a husband who finds another man with his wife; if he exposes the adultery, he will be exposing a major incident; if he is quiet about it, he will be quiet about a major matter. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not like such questions. Later on, Allah revealed the ruling of Mul&’anah [Refer to Nur 24:6-9 in the Qur’an). The Two Sahih recorded that Al-Mughirah bin Shu’bah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ “Forbade saying, ‘It was said’ and ‘He said,’ and wasting money and asking many questions.”¹¹ Muslim recorded that the Prophet ﷺ said, IM Fath Al-Bari 3 :398 , and Muslim 3 : 134 1

iLeave me as I leave you; those before you were only destroyed because of their excessive questioning and disputing with their Prophets. Therefore, when I command you with a matter, adhere to it as much as you can, and when I forbid from something, avoid it.» The Prophet ﷺ only said this after he told the Companions that Allah has ordered them to perform Hajj. A man asked, “Every year, O Messenger of Allah?” The Prophet ﷺ did not answer him, but he repeated his question three times. Then the Prophet ﷺ said, 'J&~. I ui \$J ‘fai .it aNo. Had I said yes, it would have been ordained, and you would not have been able to implement it. This is why Anas bin Malik said, “We were forbidden from asking the Messenger of Allah ﷺ about things. So we were delighted when a bedouin man would come and ask

him while we listened.”¹²¹ Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Muhammad bin Abi Muhammad told him that Ikrimah or Said said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that RaḥT bin Huraymilah or Wahb bin Zayd said, “O Muhammad! Bring us a Book sent down from heaven and which we could read, and make some rivers flow for us, then we will follow you and believe in you.” Allah sent down the answer to this challenge, j’4 m ill iOr do you want to ask your Messenger (Muhammad as Musa was asked before (i.e. show us openly our Lord)? And he who changes faith for disbelief, verily, he has gone astray from the right way^)^ Allah criticized those who ask the Messenger of Allah jg about a certain matter just for the purpose of being difficult, just as the Children of Israel asked Musa out of stubbornness, Muslim 2:975. 121 Muslim 1 :4 1 At-Tabari 2:490.

332 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) rejection and rebellion. Allah said. 4-^-? 4And he who changes faith for disbelief} meaning, whoever prefers disbelief to faith, iTjl iverily, he has gone astray frotn the right way} meaning, he has strayed from the straight path, to the path of ignorance and misguidance. This is the case of those who deviated from accepting the Prophets and obeying them and those who kept asking their Prophets unnecessary questions in defiance and disbelief, just as Allah said, aii c.'lmt jwi' J! •il iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet Muhammad sg and his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will bum and what an evil place to settle in!} (14:28-29). Abu Al-‘Aliyah commented, “They exchanged comfort for hardship.”¹¹¹ xj> -ja -jJu bi 4-j^ CJt ^S} & iii lit qt gf- iyutifj ^41 dri ^ b* ^ ijii id Uj ij'o ijfcac 4^ 4 v4 Cj -i' 6) 4109. Many of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you have believed, out ofenvyfrom their own selves, even after the truth (that Muhammad sg is Allah’s Messenger) has become manifest unto them. But forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command. Verily, Allah is able to do all things.} 4110. And perform the Salah and give the Zakdh, and whatever 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :330.

332 Tafstr Ibn Kath'r ofgood you send forth for yourselves before you, you shall find it with Allah. Certainly, Allah is the Seer ofwhat you do.}

The Prohibition of following the Ways of the People of the Book Allah warned His believing servants against following the ways of the People of Book, who publicly and secretly harbor enmity and hatred for the believers, and who envy the believers, while they recognize the virtue of the believers and their Prophet ig. Allah also commanded His believing servants to forgive them and to be patient with them, until Allah delivers His aid and victory to them. Allah commanded the believers to perform the prayer perfectly, to pay the Zakah and He encouraged them to preserve the practice of these righteous deeds. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Ka*b bin Malik said that Ka*b bin Al-Ashraf, who was a Jew and a poet, used to criticize the Prophet jg in his poems, so Allah revealed, iMany of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away..} regarding his matter. 11 ’ Also, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “An unlettered Messenger came to the People of the Scriptures confirming what they have in their own Books about the Messengers and the Ayat of Allah. He also believes in all of this, just as they believe in it. Yet, they rejected the Prophet out of disbelief, envy and transgression. This is why Allah said, \$£} iout of envy from their mvn selves, even after the truth (that Muhammad sg is Allah's Messenger) has become manifest unto them}. Allah said that after

He illuminated the truth for them, such that they were not ignorant of any of it, yet their envy made them deny the Prophet jg. Thus Allah criticized, chastised and !i| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :331

333Sura 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) denounced them.”” Allah legislated the characteristics that His Prophet and the believers should adhere to: belief, faith and accepting what Allah revealed to them and to those before them out of His generosity and tremendous kindness. Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas said that, ifrom their own selves} means, “of their making.”¹² ’ Also, Abu Al-‘Aliyah said that, jt+i IS ieven after the truth (that Muhammad jg is Allah's Messenger) has become manifest unto them > means, “After it became clear that Muhammad jg is the Messenger of Allah whom they find written of in the Torah and the Injll. They denied him in disbelief and transgression because he was not one of them.””³¹ Qatadah and Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas said similarly.¹⁴ Allah said, iBut forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command.) this is similar to His saying; os U iAnd you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from tlxose who ascribe partners to Allah (3:186). ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement, iBut forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command.) was abrogated by the Ayah, At-Tabari 2:502. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :332. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :335. 141 Ibid.

i£iE> 4Then kill the Mushrikin wherever you find them) (9:5), and, <Fi^/d against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day) (9:29) until, £j) iAndfeel themselves subdued) (9:29). Allah’s pardon for the disbelievers was repealed.” Abu Al- ‘Aliyah, Ar-Rabi* bin Anas, Qatadah and As-Suddi*²¹ said similarly: It was abrogated by the Ayah of the sword.” (Mentioned above). The Ayah, iil &~) itill Allah brings His command.) gives further support for this view, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded Usamah bin Zayd saying that the Messenger of Allah and his Companions used to forgive the disbelievers and the People of the Book, just as Allah commanded in His statement, HA l\ & oh& i &) 4But forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command. Verily, Allah is able to do all things). The Messenger of Allah 3g used to forgive them and was patient with them as Allah ordered him, until Allah allowed fighting them. Then Allah destroyed those who He decreed to be killed among the strong men of Quraysh, by the Prophet’s forces.¹³¹ The chain of narration for this text is Sahih, but I did not see its wordings in the six collections of Hadith, although the basis of it is in the Two Sahihs, narrated from Usamah bin Zayd.¹⁴¹ Ibn Abi Hfitim 1:334. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :335 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :333 Fath Al-Bari 8 :87 , and Muslim 3 : 1422

335Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) The Encouragement to perform Good Deeds Allah said, i%\\ lie ij’4 jZ. m 1 «to !>.j SjpfcSIT 4And perform the Salah and give the Zakah, and whatever of good you send forth for yourselves before you, you shall find it with Allah}. Allah encouraged the believers to busy themselves in performing deeds that would bring them benefit and reward on

the Day of Resurrection, such as prayer and paying Zakah.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 335–359]

This way, they will gain Allah’s aid in this life and on a Day when the witnesses testify, 4: ijt jj+jj pjjZ UA0£ 1 ‘£} 4The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to the Zdlimin (wrongdoers). Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (i.e. painful torment in Hell-fire)) (40:52). This is why

Allah said, 4Certainly , Allah sees what you do}, meaning, that He is never unaware of the deeds of any person, nor will these deeds be lost by Him. Whether deeds are righteous or evil, Allah will award each according to what he or she deserves based on their deeds. \j& ji d&i if ^ Jij ij tj} o—f* A fffj if oj vJUj ff ij+ii cJl»j (f 'ij VJ -fj oyOZt tfjt JLS Jil'jST ofx jJLj »; Isflji 4 ."r . Ll-> < **1 4121. And they say, ",None shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jezo or a Christian." These are their own desires. Say (O Muhammad jg), "Produce your Burhdn ifyou are truthful."} 4122. Yes! But whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah (i.e. follows Allah's religion of Islamic Monotheism) and he is a Multsin then his reward is with his Lord (Allah), on such shall

be no fear, nor shall they grieve. 4223. The Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews fallow (i.e. are not on the right religion) ; though they both recite the Scripture. Like unto their word, said those (the pagans) who know not. Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurre- tion about that wherein they have been differing.} The Hopes of the People ofthe Book Allah made the confusion of the Jews and the Christians clear, since they claim that no one will enter Paradise, unless he is a Jew or a Christian. Similarly, Allah mentioned their claims in Surat Al-Md'idah: 4We are the children ofAllah and His loved ones (5:18). Allah refuted this false claim and informed them that they will be punished because of their sins. Previously we mentioned their claim that the Fire would not touch them for more than a few days, after which they would be put in Paradise. Allah rebuked this claim, and He said about this baseless claim, J mm 'A liKP J £ (*9^* uJfij J\ S QjJl^ (jjft (1) SjV ^ 3 f (" "J? :'- J **\Ap t jjp j&i ' >. <y 'ivirijlT'A \cJjji

{These are their man desires}. Abu Al-'Aliyah commented, "These are wishes that they wished Allah would answer, without basis." * Similar was stated by Qatadah and Ar-RabT bin Anas.12 * Allah then said, 4Sm/^ meaning, "Say O Muhammad:" 4"Produce your Burhati ..."} meaning, "Your proof', as Abu Al- 'Aliyah, Mujahid, As-Suddi and Ar-RabI' bin Anas stated.131 Qatadah said that the Ayah means, "Bring the evidence that supports your statement, iifyou are truthful} in your claim."141 Allah then said, k o*&} iYes! But whoever subtnits hisface (himself) to Allah (i.e.follows Allah's religion ofIslamicMonotheism) and he is aMuhsin} meaning, "Whoever performs deeds in sincerity, for Allah alone without partners." In a similar statement, Allah said, 4^* c^j k ty} 4So if they dispute with you (Muhamtnad say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those who follow me.")} (3:20) Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-RabI' said that, 4k jfcJ ik&} 4Yes! But whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah} means, "Whoever is sincere with Allah. "sl Ibn Abi Hatim 1:336. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :336. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :337 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:337. 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :337

Also, Said bin Jubayr said that, ipd £&} iYes! But whoever submits means, he is sincere. thisface (himself)} meaning, in his religion. iatid he is a Muhsin following the Messenger jg. For there are two conditions for deeds to be accepted; the deed must be performed for Allah's sake alone and conform to the SharYah. When the deed is sincere, but does not conform to the Shari'ah, then it will not be accepted. The Messenger of Allah jfe said, "Whoever performs a deed that does not conform with our matter (religion), then it will be rejected .» This Hadith was recorded by Muslim. 121 Therefore, the good deeds of the priests and rabbis will not be accepted, even if they are sincerely for Allah alone, because these deeds do not conform with the method of the Messenger who was sent for all mankind. Allah said regarding such cases, tii ylt U \Ujjj} iAnd We shall turn to whatever deeds they (disbelievers,

polytheists, sinners) did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} (25:23) Jj* •) ifij} 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing.} (24:39) and. 1 // •/ • * > ' ,// / * <• f ^ T *,@;<ft*}*^ vIv'AST' v^" iSome faces, that Day will be humiliated. Laboring, weary. I 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :338. [21 Muslim 3:1344.

339Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) They will enter in the hot blazing Fire. They will be given to drink from a boiling spring} (88:2-5). When the deed conforms to the Shari'ah outwardly, but the person did not perform it sincerely for Allah alone, the deed will also be rejected, as in the case of the hypocrites and those who do their deeds to show off. Similarly, Allah said, Oji' JLS" ijili lilj Si' 6)^ - fa .ii iVerily, the hypocrites seek to deceive Alldlt, but it is He Who deceives them. And when they stand up for As-Salah (the prayer), they stand with laziness to be seen by people, and they do not remember Allah but little.} (4:142) and, iSo woe unto those performers of Saldh (prayers) (hypocrites). Those who delay their Saldh (from their stated fixed times). Those who do good deeds only to be seen (of men). And withhold Al-Md'tin (small kindnesses)} (107:4-7). This is why Allah said, ifj 4/"i Vj W-w* .Ay '£} \f~Jm of &} 4So whoever hopes for the meeting with his Lord, let him work righteousness and associate none as a partner in the worship of his Lord} (18:110). He also said in this Ayah, yj A pli' O* dr!/? iYes, but whoever submits his face (himself) to Allah (follows Allah's religion of Islamic Monotheism) and he is a Multsin}. Allah's statement, iShall have their reward with their Lord, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve} guaranteed them the rewards and safety from what they fear and should avoid.

iThere shall be no fear on them} in the future, 4t>&. 'is} inor shall they grieve} about what they abandoned in the past. Moreover, Said bin Jubayr said, in**& 'At "iThere shall be no fear on them} in the Hereafter, and 4»&. j* lit inor shall they grieve} about their imminent death." The Jews and Christians dispute among themselves out of Disbelief and Stubbornness Allah said, p-*J }&• }li- iS^d.I' lyJUj^ iThe Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); though they both recite the Scripture.} Allah explained the disputes, hatred and stubbornness that the People of the Book have towards each other. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When a delegation of Christians from Najran came to the Messenger of Allah jfe, the Jewish rabbis came and began arguing with them before the Messenger of Allah 5^ . Rafi' bin Huraymilah said, *You do not follow anything,' and he reiterated his disbelief in Jesus and the Injll. Then a Christian man from Najran's delegation said to the Jews, 'Rather, you do not follow anything,' and he reiterated his rejection of Musa's prophethood and his disbelief in the Torah. So Allah revealed the Ayah, m Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :338

jiiij & iji yJSJ JJ- -X, It *jif }The Jews said that the Christians follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); and the Christians said that the Jews follow nothing (i.e. are not on the right religion); though they both recite the Scripture.y^ Allah made it clear that each party read the affirmation of what they claimed to reject in their Book. Consequently, the Jews disbelieve in Jesus, even though they have the Torah in which Allah took their Covenant by the tongue of Moses to believe in Jesus. Also, the Gospel contains Jesus' assertion that Moses' prophethood and the Torah came from Allah. Yet, each party disbelieved in what the other party had. Allah said, y j£; Y 4Like unto their word, said those who know

not} thus exposing the ignorance displayed by the Jews and the Christians concerning their statements that we mentioned. There is a difference of opinion regarding the meaning of Allah's statement, iwho know not} For instance, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and Qatadah said that, i&t, V IS jli iLike unto their word, said tlwse said those who know not means, "The Christians said similar statements to the Jews."121 Ibn Jurayj asked 'Ata' "Who are those "who know not?" 'Ata' said, "Nations that existed before the Jews and the Christians and before the Torah and the Gospel."131 Also, As- Suddi said that, l 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :339. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :341 ,3] Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :340

343Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Allah's Name be mentioned (i.e. prayers and invocations) in Allah's Masjids and strive for their ruin? It was not fitting that such should themselves enter them (Allah's Masjids) except in fear. For them there is disgrace in this world, and they will have a great torment in the Hereafter.) Ofthe Most Unjust are Those Who prevent People from the Masjidsand strive for their Ruin The Quraysh idolators are those who hindered the people from the Masjids of Allah and wanted to destroy them. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Zayd said that Allah's statement. a ^qn j\$ Cr*&J 4And who are more unjust than those who forbid that Allah's Name be mentioned (i.e. prayers and invocations) in Allah's Masjids and strivefor their ruin?) is about the Quraysh idolators who prevented the Prophet from entering Makkah from Al-Hudaybiyyah, until he slaughtered the Hadi (animal for sacrifice) at Dhi-Tuwa. He then agreed to a peace treaty with the idolators and said to them, one before has ever prevented people from entering the House. One would even see the killer of his father and brother, but would not prevent him (from entering the House of Allah) .» They said, "Whoever killed our fathers at Badr, shall never enter it while there is one ofus alive." Allah's statement. iand strivefor their ruin) means those who prevent whoever maintain the Masjids with Allah's remembrance and who visit Allah's House to perform Hajj and 'C/mrah. 1 ' 1 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Quraysh prevented the Prophet from praying at the Ka'bah in Al-Masjid Al-Haram, so Allah revealed, ^ 'ti "S'A J\$ •V~* c iAnd who are more unjust than those who forbid that Allah's Name be mentioned (i.e. prayers and invocations) in AllaJt's m At-Tabari 2 :521

Masjids?}' After Allah chastised the Jews and Christians, He also criticized the idolators who expelled the Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions from Makkah, preventing them from praying in Al-Masjid Al-Haram, which they kept exclusively for their idols and polytheism. Allah said, 'i ^ & 'Jl 4Awd why should not Allah punish them tohile they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Haram, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except Al-Muttaqiin (the pious), but most of them know not.} (8:34) jjfi 'irixjpU 4ii ip {£-* c? fyfi •C^'* Cr* ^ v*~"- ^t r* jj >+*—*- uJ lA^d J wA*; it> J»j »jpLsll ^—>-'3! ilt is not for the Mushrikin (polytheists), to maintain the Masjids of Allah while they witness against their own selves of disbelief. The works of such are in vain and in Fire shall they abide. The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the SalSh, and give the Zakdh and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance.} (9:17-18) and, JWY Vjlj isxlb J^U' j* j&yiiy 1 p*} >< to \ ? r!s '4 ^ \ •* r: » ? z* »T'>' 1 * 1 jvAjiUi iy jJ Oj-ty ILi C& i£T 03 t&5 ji Scs j iThey are the ones who disbelieved and hindered you from Al-Masjid-Al-Haram (at Makkah) and detained the sacrificial Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :341

345Silruli 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice. Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill them and on

whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills - if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have punished those of them who disbelieved with painful torment (48:25). Therefore, Allah said here, *ji j *jS=»jli Ji.j ffefj j s-Vi -"j"*** 3"\$ i*The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Saldh, and give the Zakdh and fear none but Allah}. Therefore, if those believers who follow the virtues mentioned in the Ayah were prevented from attending the Masjid, then what cause for destruction is worse than this? Maintaining the Masjids not only means beautifying them, but it involves remembering Allah, establishing His Shari'ah in the Masjids and purifying them from the filth of Shirk. The Good News that Islam shall prevail Allah said next, *VI ZJLZ c? (3 u JiJf\}* it was not fitting that such should themselves enter them (Allah's Masjids) except in fear}. This Ayah means, "Do not allow them - the disbelievers - to enter the Masjids, except to satisfy the terms of an armistice or a treaty." When the Messenger of Allah ^ conquered Makkah in 9 H, he commanded that someone announce at Mina, "After the current year, no idolaters shall perform Hajj, and no naked persons shall perform Tawaf around the House, except for those who have a treaty. In this case, the treaty will be carried to the end of its term." This Ayah supports the Ayah, m Path Al-Bari 3 : 565

^ i;p:%52 £1 ip:^ 40 you who believe! (in Allah's Oneness and in His Messenger Muhammad ss)/ Verily, the Mushrikun (idolators) are Najasun (impure). So let them not come near Al-Masjid-Al-Haram (at Makkah) after this year} (9:28). It was also said that this Ayah (2:114) carries the good news for the Muslims from Allah that He will allow them to take over Al-Masjid Al-Haram and all the Masjids and disgrace the idolators. Soon after, the Ayah indicated, no idolator shall enter the House, except out of fear of being seized or killed, unless he embraces Islam. Allah fulfilled this promise and later decreed that idolators not be allowed to enter Al-Masjid Al-Haram. The Messenger of Allah sg stated that no two religions should remain in the Arabian Peninsula, and the Jews and Christians should be expelled from it, all praise is due to Allah. All of these rulings ensure maintaining the honor of Al- Masjid Al-Haram and purifying the area where Allah sent His Messenger iH to warn and bring good news to all of mankind, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him. This Ayah also described the disgrace that the disbelievers earn in this life, and that the punishment comes in a form comparable to the deed. Just as they prevented the believers from entering Al-Masjid Al-Haram, they were prevented from entering it in turn. Just as they expelled the believers from Makkah, they were in turn expelled from Makkah, *i\y* i>»Sf j i*and they will have a great torment in the Hereafter} because they breached the sanctity of the House and brought filth to it by erecting idols all around it, invoking other than Allah and performing Tawaf around it while naked, etc. Here it is worth mentioning the Hadith about seeking refuge from disgrace in this life and the torment of the Hereafter. Imam Ahmad recorded that Busr bin Artah said that the Messenger of Allah 'M, used to supplicate. *t-ojAII dill Sy* j* OjPrVj lEs ^J-\ Jtfl.* "O Allah! Make our end better in all affairs, and save us from disgrace in this life and the torment of the Hereafter.»

347 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) This Hadith is HasanJ ill ^L->i jit if-j jiii Ulife vjS} 4115. And to Allah belong the east and the west, so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne). Surely, Allah is Sufficient (for His creatures' needs), Knowing. Facing the Qiblah (Direction of the Prayer) This ruling brought comfort to the

Messenger of Allah ﷺ and his Companions, who were driven out of Makkah and had to depart from the area of Al-Masjid Al-Haram. In Makkah, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to pray in the direction of Bayt Al-Maqdis, while the Ka'bah was between him and the Qiblah. When the Messenger ﷺ migrated to Al-Madinah, he faced Bayt Al-Maqdis for sixteen or seventeen months, and then Allah directed him to face Al-Ka'bah in prayer. This is why Allah said, ^{^ ^} 4And to Allah belong the east and the west, so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne)). 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The first part of the Qur'an that was abrogated was about the Qiblah. When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ migrated to Al-Madinah, which was inhabited by the Jews, he was at first commanded to face Bayt Al-Maqdis. The Jews were happy, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ faced Bayt Al-Maqdis for some ten months. However, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ liked to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim [Al-Ka'bah at Makkah], and he used to look to the sky and supplicate. So Allah revealed, 4 j Jr ji^ 4Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Mulumumd's) face towards the heaven) until, fasrj m Ahmad 4:181

itum yourfaces (in prayer) in that direction} (2:144). The Jews were disturbed by this development and said, "What made them change the direction of the Qiblah that they used to face?" Allah revealed, 4Say (O Muhammad si) : "To Allah belong both, east and the west"} and, 4So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)}. "1 Ikrimah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4#ai iij 'E&} <(So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)) means, "Allah's direction is wherever you face, east or west."*2 Mujahid said that, 4So wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah (and He is High above, over His Throne)) means, "Wherever you may be, you have a Qiblah to face, that is, Al-Ka'bah."^ However, it was said that Allah sent down this Ayah before the order to face the Ka'bah. Ibn Jarir said, "Others said that this Ayah was revealed to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ permitting the one praying voluntary prayers to face wherever they wish in the east or west, while traveling, when in fear and when facing the enemy."*4 ' For instance, Ibn TJmar used to face whatever direction his animal was headed and proclaim that the Messenger ofAllah Si did the same, explaining the Ayah, At-Jabari 2:527. 121 Ibn Abi Hfitim 1 :347. 131 Ibn Abi Hfitim 1 :345. ' At-Tabari 2:530.

i%\ p i# CSifc> iSo wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face ofAllah}."11 ' That Hadth was also collected by Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduwah, and its origin is in the Two Sahihs from Ibn "Umar and 'Amr bin Rabl'ah without mentioning the Ayah.[2i In his Sahih, Al-Bukhari recorded that Nafi' said that whenever Ibn TJmar was asked about the prayer during times of fear, he used to describe it and would then say, "When the sense of fear is worse than that, pray while standing, or while riding, whether facing the Qiblah or not." Nafi' then said, "I think Ibn TJmar mentioned that from the Prophet ﷺ."*3 * It was also said that the Ayah was revealed about those who are unable to find the correct direction of the Qiblah in the dark or due to cloudy skies and, thus, prayed in a direction other than the Qiblah by mistake. The Qiblah for the People of Al-Madinah is what is between the East and the West In his Tafsir of this Ayah (2:115), Al-Hafiz Ibn Marduwah recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger ofAllah said, jiiij filiü ji?; ojJi jiV 5b j^IJig u» 'WJwf is between the east and the west is the Qiblah for the people ofAl-Madinah, Ash-Sham and 'Iraq.^ At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah recorded this Hadth with the wording, «5b o? aWhat is between the east and the west is a Qiblah. Ibn Jarir said, "The meaning of Allah's statement; At-Tabari 2:530.

Muslim 1:486, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:292, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 1 :244, Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :344, and Al-Hakim 2 :266. 131 Fath Al-Bari8 :46 141 Al-TJqayli 4:309. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi2:317, and Ibn Majah 1 : 323

iSurely, Allah is Sufficient (for His creatures' needs), Knowing> is that AllMi encompasses all His Creation by providing them with sufficient needs and by His generosity and favor. His statement, 4%^} 4Knowing means He is knowledgeable of their deeds and nothing escapes His watch, nor is He unaware of anything. Rather, His knowledge encompasses everything." jfj? }!y jejV'j Ojxi!' 4 ^ \$ Ji 'jJj -a' & \$ 4>*i C 1* 'ilj tjCiVf) *' 4116. And they (Jews, Christians and pagans) say: Allah has begotten a son (children or offspring). Glory is to Him (Exalted is He above all that they associate with Him). Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth, and all are Qdnitun to Him.} 4117. The Originator of the heavens and the earth. When He decrees a matter, He only says to it: "Be!" - and it is.} Refuting the Claim that Allah has begotten a Son This and the following Ayat refute the Christians, may Allah curse them, and their like among the Jews and the Arab idolators, who claimed that the angels are Allah's daughters. Allah refuted all of them in their claim that He had begotten a son. Allah said, 4%^} 4Glory is to Him.} meaning, He is holier and more perfect than such claim; ijiffij 4 u HI At-Tabari 2 : 537

351Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) 4Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth,} meaning, the truth is not as the disbelievers claimed, rather, Allah's is the kingdom of the heavens and earth and whatever and whoever is in, on and between them. Allah is the Supreme Authority in the heavens and earth, and He is the Creator, Provider and Sustainer Who decides all the affairs of the creation as He wills. All creatures are Allah's servants and are owned by Him. Therefore, how could one of them be His son? The son of any being is bom out of two comparable beings. Allah has no equal or rival sharing His grace and greatness, so how can He have a son when He has no wife? Allah said, /j 1^2 Jj %)d j/2 3 Jfjfo) jiff} \$He is the Originator of the heavens and the earth . How can He have children when He has no wife? He created all things and He is the Knoioer ofeverything} (6:101). A&ai Oj llli j&z JLaS Xie\ ^ oi !£ m \$:p& \$\$&% oy^jf 4 * %=> 4 •:£:»& iAnd they say "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son (offspring or children) " Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost tom, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins. That they ascribe a son (or offspring or children) to the Most Gracious (Allah). But it is not suitable for (the majesty of) the Most Gracious (Allah) that He should beget a son (or offspring or children). There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious (Allah) as a servant. Verily, He kncnvs each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection (without any helper, or protector or defender)} (19:88-95), and, \$&& ;J3J, p;

: "He is Allah (the) One, Allah the Samad (the Self- Sufficent, upon whom all depend), He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable to Him."} (112). In these Ayat, Allah stated that He is the Supreme Master Whom there is no equal or rival, everything and everyone was created by Him, so how can He have a son from among them? This is why, in the Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Prophet jgg said, 2 jt pj iui 2 pj pi\ If) JAS :J£ Jil Jli» IjJJ ij!5 US sLpf j\ jJi\ N jS ^tjl iljj j Jj>wi (1)1 aAllah said, 'The son ofAdam has denied Me, and that is not

his right. He has insulted Me, and that is not his right. As for the denial of Me, he claimed that I am unable to bring him back as he used to be (resurrect him). As for his insulting Me, he claimed that I have a son. All praise is due to Me, it is unbecoming that I should have a wife or a son .» This Hadith was recorded by Al-Bukhari.(11 It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah M said, “No one is more patient when hearing an insult than Allah. They attribute a son to Him, yet He still gives them sustenance and health . 12) Everything is within Allah’s Grasp Allah said, % <3^ iall are Qanitun to Him}. 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:18. ’2| Fath Al-B&ri 13 :372 , and Muslim 4 :2160.

353Sura 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-1) Ibn Abi Hatim said that Abu Said Al-Ashaj informed them that Asbat informed them from Mutarrif, from ‘Atiyah, from Ibn ‘Abbas who said that, iQdntin} (2:238) means, they pray to Him.' ' Ikrimah and Abu Malik also said that, \$and all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, bound to Him in servitude to Him.*2 * Said bin Jubayr said that Qanitun is sincerity. 131 Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas said that, iall are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, “Standing up - before Him - on the Day of Resurrection. 141 Also, As-Suddi said that, \$ ’\$} iatid all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, “Obedient on the Day of Resurrection.”*5 that Mujahid said that, Khaslf said iand all are Qdnitiin to Him.} means, “Obedient. He says, *Be a human’ and he becomes a human.”*61 He also said, “(Allah says,) *Be a donkey’ and it becomes a donkey.” Also, Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that, {and all are Qdnitiin to Him.} 1,1 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :349. 121 Ibid. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :350. 141 Ibid. 151 At-Jabari 2 :538 161 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:349.

means, obedient. Mujahid also said, “The obedience of the disbeliever occurs when his shadow prostrates, while he hates that.” Mujahid’s statement, which Ibn Jarir preferred, combines all the meanings, and that is that Qunut means obedience and submission to Allah. There are two categories of Qunut legislated and destined, for Allah said, }And unto Allah (alone) falls in prostration whoever is in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly, and so do their shadows in the mornings and in the (late) afternoons} (13:15). The Meaning ofBadV Allah said, 4The Badf (Originator) of the heavens and the earth.} which means, He created them when nothing resembling them existed. Mujahid and As-Suddi said that this is the linguistic meaning, for all new matters are called Bid'ah. Muslim recorded the Messenger of Allah saying, J, < * * # p S * * ’ “ . . every innovation (in religion) is a Bid'ah. There are two types of Bid'ah, religious, as mentioned in the Hadith: JSj le-Xi jJbLl JS *...every innovation is a Bid'ah and every Bid'ah is heresy. And there is a linguistic Bid'ah, such as the statement of the Leader of the faithful Umar bin Al-Khattab when he gathered the Muslims to pray the Tarawih prayer in congregation (which was also an earlier practice of the Prophet jg) and said, “What a good Bid'ah this is.” Ibn Jarir said, “Thus the meaning of the Ayat (2:116-117) becomes, ‘Allah is far more glorious than to have had a son, m Ibn AbiHStim 1:348. Muslim 2:592.

for He is the Owner of everything that is in the heavens and earth. All testify to His Oneness and to their submissiveness to Him. He is their Creator and Maker. Without created precedence, He shaped the creatures in their current shapes. Allah also bears witness to His servants that Jesus, who some claimed to be Allah’s son, is among those who testify to His Oneness. Allah stated that He created the heavens and earth out of nothing and without precedent. Likewise, He created Jesus, the Messiah, with His power and without a father.” This explanation from Ibn Janr, may Allah have mercy upon him, is very good and correct. Allah said, 4oJ^* if \$ J 4When He decrees a matter, He only says to it : "Be!" - and it

is.} thus, demonstrating His perfectly complete ability and tremendous authority; if He decides a matter. He merely orders it to, 'Be' and it comes into existence. Similarly, Allah said, 4 fsfffs ^ff /J Jyj J lili.\$ iij 4 Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is.} (36:82), 4 if ^ f ^4 iVerily, Our Word unto a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it: "Be!" - and it is.} (16:40) and, 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) So Allah informed us that He created Jesus by merely saying, "Be!" and he was, as Allah willed: 44E'r* if \$ 3b A y'J is 4Verily, the likeness of 'Isa (Jesus) before Allah is the likeness of m At-Tabari 2 :550.

357Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 Messengers of Allah had received." Allah blows best with whom to place His Message. Humiliation and disgrace from Allah and a severe torment will overtake the criminals (polytheists and sinners) for that which they used to plot.} (6:124) and iAnd they say: "We shall not believe in you (O Muhammad \$£), until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us} until, w ^ j-» 4j iSay (O Mulmmmad : "Glorified (and Exalted) be my Lord [(Allah) above all that evil they (polytheists) associate with Him)! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?"} (17:90-93) and, iCj& ') \LS VJJ UU) <Z>JrC. V 1\$ iAnd those who expect not a meeting with Us (i.e. those who deny the Day of Resurrection and the life of the Hereafter) said "Why are not the angels sent down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?"} (25:21) and, yJX* U>W» J iNay, everyone of them desires that he should be given pages spread out} (74:52). There are many other Ayat that testify to the disbelief of the Arab idolators, their transgression, stubbornness, and that they asked unnecessary questions out of disbelief and arrogance. The statements of the Arab idolators followed the statements of the nations of the People of the Two Scriptures and other religions before them. Allah said, iThe People of the Scripture (Jews) ask you to cause a book to descend upon them from heaven. Indeed, they asked Musa (Moses) for even greater than that, when they said : "Show us

truth (Islam), a bringer of glad tidings (for those who believe in what you brought, that they will enter Paradise) and a wamer (for those who disbelieve in what you brought, that they will enter the Hellfire) . And you will not be asked about the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} Allah's statement; iAnd you will not be asked about the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} means, "We shall not ask you about the disbelief of those who rejected you." Similarly, Allah said, itids t&j gjr til} iYour duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning.} (13:40) 0—3 Oil J(li) 4So remind them (O Muhammad jg) - you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.}(88:21-22) and, iWe know best what they say. And you (O Muhammad jg) are not the one to force them (to belief). But warn by the Qur'an; him who fears My threat} (50:45). There are many other similar Ayat. The Description of the Prophet in the Tawrah Imam Ahmad recorded 'Ata' bin Yasar saying that he met 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin A1-'As and said to him, "Tell me about

the description of the Messenger of Allah sg in the Torah." He

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 359–376]

said, "Yes, by Allah, he is described by the Torah with the same characteristics that he is described with in the Qur'an with: 'O Prophet! We have sent you as a witness, a bringer of good news, a wamer, and as safe refuge for the unlettered people. You are My servant and Messenger. I have called you the

Mutawakkil (who depends and relies on Allah for each and everything). You are not harsh, nor hard, nor obnoxious in the bazaars. He does not reward the evil deed with an evil deed.

360 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Rather, he forgives and pardons. Allah will not bring his life to an end, until he straightens the wicked's religion by his hands so that the people proclaim: There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. By his hands, Allah will open blind eyes, deaf ears and sealed hearts.”¹¹¹ This was recorded by Al-Bukhari only. ¹² ' kii \$ M& ji pL g £ Sj J^i it;& &} Ji\$ Sj & £ o; Jit jjillyil 4 ^ ibljli j-j . * jljJJ vjujl jCjii 4120. Never will the Jews nor the Christians be pleased with you (O Muhammad jgj till you follow their religion. Say: "Verily, the guidance of Allah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance. And if you (O Mulymimad jg) were to follow their (Jews and Christians) desires after what you have received of Knowledge (i.e. the Qur'an), then you would have against Allah neither any Wall (protector or guardian) nor any helper.} 4121. Those to whom we gave the Book recite it as it should be recited (Yatlunahu Haqqa Tilawatihi) they are the ones who believe therein. And whoso disbelieve in it, those are they who are the losers.} Ibn Jarir said, "Allah said, (f Sr&& % &L £} 4Never ivill the Jews nor the Christians be pleased with you (O Muhammad sg) till you follow their religion.} meaning, "The Jews and the Christians will never be happy with you, O Muhammad! Therefore, do not seek what pleases or appeases them, and stick to what pleases Allah by calling them to the truth that Allah sent you with.' Allah's statement, iktti ;im \$} 4Say: "Verily, the guidance of Allah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance" } 1,1 Ahmad 2:174. Fath Al-Bari⁴ :402 , 8 :449 , and Al-AdabAl-Mufrad 72

362 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (101 - 224) (Part-1 means, 'Say, O Muhammad jg, the guidance of Allah that He sent me with is the true guidance, meaning the straight, perfect and comprehensive religion.' Qatadah said that Allah's statement, (fi} iSay : "Verily, the guidance of Allah (i.e. Islamic Monotheism) that is the (only) guidance} is, "A true argument that Allah taught Muhammad % and his Companions and which they used against the people of misguidance ”¹²¹ Qatadah said, "We were told that the .*) ^ 4ji(^ S ^ S ^==>JAj {jC&LjtijJU^UaU "IS Messenger of Allah used to say, ,_f>- j^iJU y> ^ ij^ J* J'j3 «-d)l ^jU «There will always be a group of my Ummah fighting upon the truth, having the upper hand, not harmed by their opponents, until the decree of Allah (the Last Hour) comes. »[³¹ This Hadith was collected in the Sahih and narrated from Abdullah bin Amr.*⁴ ' 111 At-Tabari 2:562. I2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :356 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :355. 141 Muslim 1924.

362 Tafstr Ibn Kathir "5« d 4And if you (O Muhammad jg) were to follow their (Jews and Christians) desires after what you have received of Knowledge (i.e. the Qur'an), then you would have against Allah neither any Walt (protector or guardian) nor any helper This Ayah carries a stern warning for the Muslim Ummah against imitating the ways and methods of the Jews and Christians, after they have acquired knowledge of the Qur'an and Sunnah, may Allah grant us refuge from this behavior. Although the speech in this Ayah was directed at the Messenger ag, the ruling of which applies to his entire Ummah. The Meaning of Correct Tilawah Allah said, 4Those to whom We gave the Book. Yatliinahu Haqqan Tildwatih.} 'Abdur-Razzaq said ag from Ma'mar, from Qatadah, "They are the Jews and Christians." This is the opinion of 'Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and it was also chosen by Ibn Jarir. Said reported from Qatadah, "They are the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ag." Abu Al-'Aliyah said that Ibn Mas*ud said, "By He in Whose Hand is my soul! The right Tilawah is allowing

what it makes lawful, prohibiting what it makes unlawful, reciting it as it was revealed by Allah, not changing the words from their places, and not interpreting it with other than its actual interpretation.” ””
 As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik from Ibn ‘Abbas who said about this Ayah (2:121): “They make lawful what it allows and they prohibit what it makes unlawful, and they do not alter its wordings.”*2’
 Tjmar bin Al-Khattab said, “They are those who when they recite an Ayah that mentions mercy, they ask Allah for it, and when they recite an Ayah that mentions torment, they seek refuge with Allah from it.”*3 * This meaning was attributed to AMabari 2:567. At-Jabari 2:567. * Al-Qurtubi 2 :95

363 Surah 2. Al-Bacjarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) the Prophet 3g, for when he used to recite sin Ayah of mercy, he invoked Allah for mercy, and when he recited an Ayah of torment, he sought refuge from it with Allah. Allah’s statement, ^3^ ithey are the ones who believe therein) explains the Ayah, iThose to whom We gave the Book. Yatliinahu Haqqa Tilawatihi). These Ayat mean, “Those among the People of the Book who perfectly adhered to the Books that were revealed to the previous Prophets, will believe in what 1 have sent you with, O Muhammad!” Allah said in another Ayah, <A;td i/ only they had acted according to the Tawrdh, the Itijil, and what has (now) been sent down to them front their Lord (the Qur’an), they would surely, have gotten provision from above them andfrom underneath their feet.) (5:66). The Ayah, iSay (O Muhammad jg) "O People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! You have nothing (as regards guidance) till you act according to the Tawrdh, the Injtl, and what has (now) been salt down to you from your Lord (the Qur’an).”) means, “If you adhere to the Torah and the Gospel in the correct manner, believe in them as you should, and believe in the news they carry about Muhammad’s prophethood, his description and the command to follow, aid and support him, then this will direct you to adhere to truth and righteousness in this life and the Hereafter.” In another Ayah, Allah said, 111 Ibn Majah 429

364 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4 isil OJJfi L\$fy 4 i >\ii'. iThose who folloiu the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write (i.e. Muhammad jg) whom they find written with them in the Tawrah and the Injit.) (7:157) and, <r. (**?' SJ' oj 'y^y S y ** j»jr i *>> > >-* "V/"WJ o» b*; 4^>v—> Ijj*— ^Sfli/ fO Muhammad to them): "Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled (17:107-108). These Ayat indicate that what Allah promised for Muhammad ag will certainly occur. Allah also said, *) *#i £*'* 5^ pj-k drl^ + ' ' >*" t >'A \ 'JL/fr*# w ,J» iji Or, Cl LLy AtLjl iTlwse to whom We gave the Scripture (i.e. the Tawrah and the Ittijil) before it, they believe in it (the Qur’an). And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from those who submit themselves to Allah in Islam as Muslims. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient, and repel evil with good, and spend (in charity) out of what We have provided them.) (28:52-54) and, tear *3 viz 3 u*%& &t u& i,£ii tfC 4gif iAnd say to those who were given tlw Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do you (also) submit yourselves (to Allah in Islam)?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message; and Allah is the Seer of (His)

365 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 servants (3:20), Allah said, 4And whoever disbelieves in it (the Qur'an), those are they who are the losers}, just as He said in another Ayah, Ji 4But those of the

sects (Jews, Christians and all the other non- Muslim nations) that reject it (the Qur'an), the Fire will be their promised meeting place} (11:17). As recorded in the Sahih, the Prophet sg said, lyty. V VJ 'l?. •*»-' £*—i V i-iti «30I Jis VI ^ «By He in Wlwse Hand is my soul! There is no member of this Ummah (mankind and Jinns), Jew or a Christian, who hears of me, yet does not believe in me, but will enter the Fire. s' 11 p* Vj jili V> Jj* Vj ^ ^sjr 4122. O Children of Israel! Remember My favor which I bestowed upon you and that I preferred you aver the nations).} 4123. And fear the Day (of Judgement) when no person shall avail another, nor shall compensation be acceptedfrom him, nor shall intercession be of use to him, nor shall they be helped.} We mentioned a similar Ayah at the beginning of this Surah, and it is mentioned here to emphasize the importance of following the Ummi Prophet and Messenger, who is described for the People of the Scriptures in their Books by his characteristics, name, the good news about him and the description of his Ummah. Allah warned them against concealing this information, which is among the favors that Allah granted them. Allah also commanded them to remember their daily life and their religious affairs and how He blessed I 1 ' Muslim 1 :134.

them. They should not envy their cousins, the Arabs, for what Allah has given them, the Final Messenger of Allah being an Arab. Envy should not incite them to oppose or deny the Prophet or refrain from following him, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him until the Day of Judgment. Jlj iri-j JS 4 JC y 4124. And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (Abraham) tried him with (certain) commands, which he fulfilled. He (Allah) said (to him), "Verily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind (to follmo you)." (Ibrahim) said, "And of my offspring (to make leaders)." (Allah) said, "My covenant (prophethood) includes not Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers) . " } Ibrahim Al-Khalfl was anImam for the People Allah is informing us of the honor of Ibrahim Al-KhaM, who He made an Imam for the people, and a model to be imitated, because of the way he conducted himself and adhered to TawhicL. This honor was given to Prophet Ibrahim when he adhered to Allah's decisions and prohibitions. This is why Allah said, kJ i nib iAnd (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (i.e., Allah) tried him with (certain) commands}. This Ayah means, O Muhammad! Remind the idolaters and the People of the Scriptures, who pretend to be followers of the religion of Ibrahim, while in reality they do not follow it, while you, O Muhammad, and your followers are the true followers of his religion; remind them of the commands and prohibitions that Allah tested Ibrahim with. iwhich he fulfilled.} indicating that Ibrahim implemented all of Allah's orders. Allah said in another Ayah,

367Surah 2. Al-Bacjarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) iAtid of Ibrahim (Abraham) who fulfilled (or conveyed) all that (Allah ordered him to do or convey)} (53:37) meaning, he was truthful and he was obedient to Allah's legislation. Also, Allah said, V Cxi^ jljl Jji lijli iil s pj . j /*j)j S: .» LljJt j ajuwj —* fire 3) t*j iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah (or a nation), obedient to Allah, Hanif (i.e. to worship none but Allah), and he was not one of those who were Al-Mushrikin (polytheists), (He was) thankful for His (Allah's) favors. He (Allah) chose him and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous. Then, We have sent the revelation to you (O Muhammad jg saying) "Folloiv the religion of Ibrahim Hanif (Islamic Monotheism - to worship none but Allah) and he was not of the Mushrikin . } (16:120-123) cn o'? Cj Ip 'p»\$\\ ilj C» fCcZi jp -fo jku 4S&&C2f iSay (O Multammad \$£) : "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrdhim, Hanifan, and Ibrahim (to worship none but Allah, alone) and he was not ofAl-Mushrikin."} (6:161) and, i & yt c;; ip: & dp% {£ >* c} K%% fee 4i <&£ UP fo&h & ilbrahim was

neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifan (Islamic Monotheism - to worship none but Allah alone) and he was not of Al-Mushrikin. Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet (Muhammad ﷺ) and those who have believed (Muslims). And Allah is the Wali (Protector and Helper) of the believers (3:67-68). Allah said,

with Kalimdt (words)} which means, “Laws, commandments and prohibitions.” “Words’ as mentioned here, sometimes refers to what Allah has willed, such as Allah’s statement about Maryam, *4^5 Qj Hxij} iAnd site testified to the truth of the Words of her Lord, and (also believed in) His Scriptures, and she was of the Qdnitin (i.e. obedient to Allah)} (66:12). “Words” also refers to Allah’s Law, such as Allah’s statement, i’tiej liJLj ip i-^j} iAnd tlte Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:1 15) meaning, His legislation. “Words” also means truthful news, or a just commandment or prohibition. For instance, Allah said, iAnd (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim tried him with (certain) Words (commands), which hefidfilled} meaning, he adhered to them, Allah said, i&c. t jjUJJ ike 4\$ i"Verily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind (tofollow you)."} as a reward for Ibrahim’s good deeds, adhering to the commandments and avoiding the prohibitions. This is why Allah made Ibrahim a role model for the people, and an Imam whose conduct and path are imitated and followed. What were the Words that Ibrahim was tested with? There is a difference of opinion over the words that Allah tested Ibrahim with. There are several opinions attributed to Ibn ‘Abbas. For instance, ‘Abdur-Razzaq said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah tested him with the rituals (of Hop).” * Abu Ishaq reported the same.*2 ‘Abdur-Razzaq also narrated that Ibn ** At-Jabari 3:13. ' Ibid.

369Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 ‘Abbas said that, 'i-r&i fij £& iAnd (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim (Abraham) (i.e., Allah) tried him with (certain) commands^ means, “Allah tested him with Taharah (purity, ablution): five on the head and five on the body. As for the head, they are cutting the mustache, rinsing the mouth, inhaling and discarding water, using Siwak and parting the hair. As for the body, they are trimming the nails, shaving the pubic hair, circumcision and plucking under the arm and washing with water after answering the call of nature.” 111 Ibn Abi Hatim said, “A similar statement was also reported from Said bin Al- Musayyib, Mujahid, Ash-Sha*bi, An-Nakhal, Abu Salih, Abu Al-Jald, and so forth.”121 There is a similar statement that Imam Muslim narrated from ‘A’ishah who said that Allah’s Messenger said, ‘yjj tdl ilplj idi1} ^jdJi lyx5 4\~iy\4\ fdi suit jUj yy\ l&j yS) jUtVi «Te« are among the Fitrah (mstinct, natural constitution): trimming the mustache, growing the beard, using Siwak, inhaling and then exhaling water (in ablution), cutting the nails, washing between the fingers (in ablution), plucking the underarm hair, shaving the pubic hair, washing with water after answering the call of nature, (and I forgot the tenth, I think it was) rinsing the mouth (in ablution)Ji3] The Two Sahihs recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that the Prophet jfe said, i*jcj jUtSn y&j ^jdii yuj »jiuiu «Five are among the acts of Fitrah : circumcision, shaving the pubic hair, trimming the mustache, cutting the nails and plucking the underarm hairJ This is the wording with 111 ‘Abdur-Razzaq 1 :57. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :359. 131 Muslim 1 :223

Muslim.111 Muhammad bin Ishaq reportd that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The words that Allah tested Ibrahim with, and that he implemented were: abandoning his (disbelieving) people when Allah commanded him to do so, disputing with Nimrod (king of Babylon) about Allah, being patient when he was thrown in the fire (although this was extremely traumatic) migrating from his homeland when Allah commanded

him to do so, patience with the monetary and material demands of hosting guests by Allah's command, and Allah's order for him to slaughter his son. When Allah tested Ibrahim with these words, and he was ready for the major test, Allah said to him, 0, cJlJ 36 i"Submit (be a Muslim)!" He said, "I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of all that exists."} (2:131) although this meant defying and being apart from the people."121 The Unjust do not qualify for Allah's Promise Allah said that Ibrahim said, i&j} cm} iAnd of my offspring (to make leaders)} and Allah replied, iMy covenant (prophethood) includes not Zalimin (polytheists and wrongdoers)}. When Allah made Ibrahim an Imam (Leader for the faithful), he asked Allah that Imams thereafter be chosen from his offspring. Allah accepted his supplication, but told him that there will be unjust people among his offspring and they will not benefit from Allah's promise. Thus, they will neither become Imams nor be imitated (for they will not be righteous). The proof that Ibrahim's supplication to Allah was accepted is that Allah said in Surat Al-'Ankabut (29:27), Fath Al-Bari 10:347 and Muslim 1 :222. ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :360.

4^05 giif 4 We ordained among his offspring prophethood and Ite Book). Hence, every Prophet whom Allah sent after Ibrahim were from among his offspring, and every Book that Allah revealed was to them. As for Allah's statement, i(Allah) said, "My covenant (prophethood) includes not Zdlun (polytheists and wrongdoers).") Allah mentioned that there are unjust people among the offspring of Ibrahim, and they will not benefit from Allah's promise, nor would they be entrusted with anything, even though they are among the children of Allah's Khalil (intimate friend, Prophet Abraham). There will also be those who do good among the children of Ibrahim, and these it is who will benefit from Ibrahim's supplication. Ibn Jarir said that th'is Ayah indicated that the unjust shall not be Imams for the people. Moreover, the Ayah informed Ibrahim that there will be unjust people among his offspring. Also, Ibn Khuwayz Mindad Al-Maliki said, "The unjust person does not qualify to be a Khalifah, a ruler, one who gives religious verdicts, a witness, or even a narrator (of Hadiths)." 4 J-** jt c*J' tU?- ilf) 4125. And (remember) when We made the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) a place of resort for mankind and a place of safety. And take you (people) the Maqdrn (place) of Ibrahim (or the stone on which Ibrahim as a place) The Virtue of Allah's House Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4And (remember) when We made the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) a place of resort for mankind) "They do not remain in the House, they only visit it and return

372 Tafstr Ibn Kathir to their homes, and then visit it again." Also, Abu Ja'far Ar- Razi narrated from Ar-Rabi* bin Anas from Abu Al-'Aliyah who said that, 5 o-M c^f oz ii;> iAnd (remember) when We made the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) a place of resort for mankind and a place of safety} means, "Safe from enemies and armed conflict. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people were often victims of raids and kidnapping, while the people in the area surrounding it (Al Masjid Al-Haram) were safe and not subject to kidnapping."11 Also, Mujahid, 'Ata', As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas were reported to have said that the Ayah (2:125) means, "Whoever enters it shall be safe."21 This Ayah indicates that Allah honored the Sacred House, which Allah made as a safe refuge and safe haven. Therefore, the souls are eager, but never bored, to conduct short visits to the House, even every year. This is because Allah accepted the supplication of His Khalil, Ibrahim, when he asked Allah to make the hearts of people eager to visit the House. Ibrahim said (14:40), iOur Lord! And accept my invocation}. Allah described the House as a safe resort and refuge, for those who visit it are safe, even if they had committed acts of evil. This honor comes from the honor of the person who built it first,

Khalil Ar-Rahman, just as Allah said, V o' olj' iAnd (remember) when We showed Ibrahim the site of the (Sacred) House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) (saying) : "Associate not anything (in worship) with Me..." } (22:26) and, 2% cl & At-Tabari 3 :29 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :370.

373 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1 iVerily, the first House (of worship) appointed for mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin (mankind and Jinn). In it are manifest signs (for example), the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security (3 :96-97). The last honorable Ayah emphasized the honor of Ibrahim's Maqam, and the instruction to pray next to it, iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer The Maqam of Ibrahim Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that Sa'id bin Jubayr commented on the Ayah, iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer» "The stone (Maqam) is the standing place of Ibrahim, Allah's Prophet, and a mercy from Allah. Ibrahim stood on the stone, while Ismail was handing him the stones (constructing the Ka'bah)." ^ As-Suddi said, "The Maqam of Ibrahim is a stone which Ismail's wife put under Ibrahim's feet when washing his head ." 121 Al-Qurtubi mentioned this, but he considered it unauthentic, although others gave it preference, Ar-Razi reported it in his Tafsir from Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas . Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Jabir, describing the Hajj (pilgrimage) of the Prophet jg said, "When the Prophet jfe performed Tawaf Umar asked him, Is this the Maqam of our father?' He said, 'Yes.' Umar said, 'Should we take it a place of prayer?' So Allah revealed, Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :371 At-Tabari 3:35. t3 ' Ar-Razi 4 :45

375 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (101 - 124) (Part-1) Hadith that Muslim recorded in Sahih. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Amr bin Dinar said that he heard Ibn 'Umar say, "The Messenger of Allah jg performed Tawaf around the House seven times and then prayed two Rak'ahs behind the Afagdm." *21 All these texts indicate that the Maqdm is the stone that Ibrahim was standing on while building the House. As the House's walls became higher, Ismail brought his father a stone, so that he could stand on it, while Ismail handed him the stones. Ibrahim would place the stones on the wall, and whenever he finished one side, he would move to the next side, to complete the building all around. Ibrahim kept repeating this until he finished building the House, as we will describe when we explain the story of Ibrahim and Ismail and how they built the House, as narrated from Ibn 'Abbas and collected by Al-Bukhari. Ibrahim's footprints were still visible in the stone, and the Arabs knew this fact during the time of JahiUyyah. This is why Abu Talib said in his poem known as 'Al-Lamiyyah', "And Ibrahim's footprint with his bare feet on the stone is still visible." The Muslims also saw Ibrahim's footprints on the stone, as Anas bin Malik said, "I saw the Maqdm with the print of Ibrahim's toes and feet still visible in it, but the footprints dissipated because of the people rubbing the stone with their hands." Earlier, the Maqdm was placed close to the Ka'bah's wall. In the present time, the Maqdm is placed next to Al-Hijr on the right side of those entering through the door. When Ibrahim finished building the House, he placed the stone next to the wall of Al-Ka'bah. Or, when the House was finished being built, Ibrahim just left the stone where it was last standing, and he was commanded to pray next to the stone when he finished the Tawdf (circumambulating). It is understandable that the Maqdm of Ibrahim would stand where the building of the House ended. The Leader of the faithful "Umar bin Al-Khattab, one of the Four Rightly Guided Caliphs whom we were commanded to emulate, moved the stone away 111 Muslim 2:920. ,2) Fath Al-B&ri 3 :586

from the Ka'bah's wall during his reign. 'Umar is one of the two men, whom the Messenger of Allah described when he said, «Imitate the two men who will come after me: Abu Bakr and 'Umar.» [1] 'Umar was also the person whom the Qur'an agreed with

regarding praying next to Maqam of Ibrahim. This is why none

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 376–380]

among the Companions rejected it when he moved it. 'Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ibn Jurayj from 'Ata', "Umar bin Al-Khattab moved the Maqam back." Also, 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Mujahid said that Umar was the first person who moved the Maqam back to where it is now standing." Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr, Ahmad bin 'Ali bin Al-Husayn Al-Bayhaqi recorded 'A'ishah saying, "During the time of the Messenger of Allah and Abu Bakr, the Maqam was right next to the House. Umar moved the Maqam during his reign." This Hadith has an authentic chain of narration. J' il> OiyJtU Csre. £4} JJ', 'JZ Jy "l jit fdri O*' y 40*^ Jt jW jjj[> Vh 1* bl* 'i* J*»-' Cjj U?Si\ crt JLt'ji' ^y Hj •T-'yy tijjj kiii —* LU-ij L, Jjuui ^ u> jii ufj j ^ kiljl iJ* k-y l'k—U-» \ijj kill 4125. And We commanded Ibrahim (Abraham) and Isma'il (Ishmael) that they should purify My House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) for those who are circumambulating it, or staying (I'tikaf), or bowing or prostrating themselves (there, in prayer).} }126. And (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day." He (Allah) answered : "As for him who disbelieves, I shall leave him in contentment for a while, then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!"} m Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi :569.

377 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) 4127. And (remember) when Ibrahim and (his son) Isma'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) , (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower."} 4128. "Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and show us our Manasik, and accept our repentance. Truly, You are the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.} The Command to purify the House Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that, 4 And We gave Our 'Ahd (command) to Ibrahim and Isma'il} means, "Allah ordered them to purify it from all filth and impurities, of which none should ever touch it."11 ' Also, Ibn Jurayj said, "I said to 'Ata', What is Allah's 'Ahd?' He said, *His command." Also, Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, ^ 3} 4 that they should purify My House (the Ka'bah) for those who are circumambulating it, or staying (1'tikaf)} ^ imu >m» Vi ZZJSj ijl LJj! Jjjj ^j&i JJIs ^,ij\j 4-i; i (jp\$ Qwllij 'Ojcull J1S y*» gullpO 1*^5'« J, 111 Ibn Abi flatim 1 :373.

"Purify it from the idols." Further, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said that, 4*i'M& ipurifyMy Housefor those who are circumambulating it} means, "From the idols, sexual activity, false witness and sins of all kinds." Allah said, ifor those who are performing Tawaf (circumambulating) it}. The Tawaf around the House is a well-established ritual, Said bin Jubayr said that, ifor those who are circumambulating it} means, strangers (he means who do not live in Makkah), while; ior staying (1'tikaf)} is about those who live in the area of the Sacred House. Also, Qatadah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said that Ttikaf is in reference to those who live in the area of the House, just as Said bin Jubayr stated.'21 Allah said, ior bowing or prostrating themselves (there, in prayer)} Ibn 'Abbas said, when it is a place of prayer it

includes those who are described as bowing and prostrating themselves.’³ Also, ‘Ata’ and Qatadah offered the same Tafsir.[^] Purifying all Masjids is required according to this Ayah and according to Allah’s statement, i-g&M jii’L £ % cp.&£ 3%4 & m Ibn Abi HStim 1 :375. ’ Ibid. ’ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 376. ’ Ibid.

in houses (mosques) which Allah has ordered to be raised (to be cleaned, and to be honored), in them His Name is remembered (i.e. Adhan, Iqdmah, Salah, invocations, recitation of the Qur'an). Therein glorify Him (Allah) in the mornings and in the (late) afternoons> (24:36). There are many Hadiths that give a general order for purifying the Masjids and keeping filth and impurities away from them. This is why the Prophet said, UJ Jb-Lldl U;i» (‘The Masjids are established for the purpose that they were built for (i.e. worshipping Allah alone). »*) I have collected a book on this subject, and all praise is due to Allah. Makkah is a Sacred Area Allah said, £*h>M rri 3** 3* Cfi iify\ J6 iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day.") Imam Abu JaTar bin Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jLij 'ji <. Cs?. ^ 4tl cJj f'ji- j)1 UoLu> 1Ibrahim made Allah's House a Sacred Area and a safe refuge. I have made wltw is between the two sides of Al-Madinah a Sacred Area. Therefore, its game should not be hunted, and its trees should not be cut.s,2] An-Nasal131 and Muslim14 ’ also recorded this Hadith. 111 Muslim 1 :397 121 At-Tabari 3:47. 131 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 2 :487 ’4 ’ Muslim 2 :992

There are several other Hadiths that indicate that Allah made Makkah a sacred area before He created the heavens and earth. The Two Sahihs recorded ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas saying that the Messenger of Allah sg said, 4)1 jqs < 'jj*jSllj OI^Lt.1 1 ^yi *1)1 jJbl I-1a j| E <j}P iri J JP. pJ Jp pH P JP. p P pi lajfoj 'ij taJL yLi 'jj *syi Xjl*j 'i iilliJl (*3l J ' Vt'V P'P' Ji v'i :ji)i J^3 U» :>&3i Jia «U^U ^ ^ iikiJ lAllah has made this city a sanctuary (sacred place) the Day He created the heavens and earth . Therefore, it is a sanctuary until

the Day of Resurrection because Allah made it a sanctuary. It

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 380–436]

was not legal for anyone to fight in it before me, and it was legal for me for a few hours of one day. Therefore, it is a sanctuary until the Day of Resurrection, because Allah made it a sanctuary. None is allowed to uproot its thorny shrubs, or to chase its game, or to pick up something that has fallen, except by a person who announces it publicly, nor should any of its trees be cut.v Al-‘Abbas said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Except the lemon-grass, for our goldsmiths and for our graves.’ The Prophet added, «Except lemon-grassJ This is the wording of Muslim. The Two Sahihs also recorded Abu Hurayrah narrating a similar Hadith, while Al-Bukhari recorded a similar Hadith from Safiyyah bint Shaybah who narrated it from the Prophet j£. Abu Shurayh Al-‘Adawi said that he said to ‘Amr bin Said while he was sending armies to Makkah, “O Commander! Let me narrate a Hadith that the Messenger of Allah a£s said the day that followed the victory of Makkah. My ears heard the Hadith, my heart comprehended it, and my eyes saw the Prophet -jig when he said it. He thanked Allah and praised him and then said. ypi\ *4 ss/i j~l * >&'WX p) *1 &k . I 1 * Fath Al-Bari4:56, and Muslim 2:986. *21 Fath AbBdri3J253.

5^1; J 1 ' d.j—j jj Yj to wlglj 01 Or? i*ti L\$J Oil UJlj i^iU jjU JUj tlj-'A Oi^ ill OJ :ljJ>i» •wliil -IalIJI *J~Jj ^p-iS/L ^13 1 lfi>»y>- ojU 8Allah, not the people, made Makkah a sanctuary, so any person ivho has belief in Allah and the Last Day, should neither shed blood in it nor should he cut down its trees. If anybody argues that fighting in it is permissible on the basis that Allah's Messenger fought in Makkah, say to him, 'Allah allowed His Messenger and did not allow you.' Allah allowed me only for a few hours on that day (of the Conquest), and today its sanctity is valid as it was before. So, those who are present should inform those xoho are absent (concerning this fact). Abu Shurayh was asked, What did 'Amr reply?' He said, ('Amr said) 'O Abu Shurayh! I know better than you about this, the Sacred House does not give protection to a sinner, a murderer or a thief.' This Hadith was collected by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.¹¹¹ After this, there is no contradiction between the Hadlths that stated that Allah made Makkah a sanctuary when He created the heavens and earth and the Hadiths that Ibrahim made it a sanctuary, since Ibrahim conveyed Allah's decree that Makkah is a sanctuary, before he built the House. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah jg was written as the Final Prophet when Adam was still clay. Yet, Ibrahim said, iOur Lord! Send amongst them a Messenger of their own (2:129). Allah accepted Ibrahim's supplication, although He had full knowledge beforehand that it will occur by His decree. To further elaborate on this subject, we should mention the Hadith about what the Messenger of Allah jg said when he was asked, "O Messenger of Allah! Tell us about how your prophethood started." He said, £>-^ jJ iy-il 111 Fath Al-Bari 4 :50, and Muslim 2 :987.

jj -i<3i a/ jji </< the supplication ofmy father Ibrahim, the good news of Jesus, the son of Mary, and my mother saw a light that radiated from her which illuminated the castles of Ash-Sham (Syria).*" In this Hadith, the Companions asked the Messenger about the beginning of his prophethood. We will explain this matter later, ifAllah wills. Ibrahim invokes Allah to make Makkah an Area of Safety and Sustenance Allah said that Ibrahim said, ! ltd? 'j> jlj.1 Cfj} }My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security} (2:126) from terror, so that its people do not suffer from fear. Allah accepted Ibrahim's supplication. Allah said, ^liX j£ /tU-J jZj} 4Whosoever enters it, he attains security} (3:97) and, St LX lt^£" li*»- xy_ }Have they not seen that We have made (Makkah) a secure sanctuary, while men are being snatched away from all around them?} (29:67). We have already mentioned the Hadiths that prohibit fighting in the Sacred Area. Muslim recorded that Jabir said that the Messenger of Allah said, «£*Ul if •No one is allowed to carry weapons in MakkahV21 Allah mentioned that Ibrahim said, (i* Jiil CJj} *** Ahmad 5:262. 121 MusUm 2 :989

iMy Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place ofsecurity} meaning, make this a safe city. This occurred before the Ka'bah was built. Allah said in Surat Ibrahim, -43' l-ilb yj Jli ilj} iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Make this city (Makkah) one ofpeace and security..."} (14:35) as here, Ibrahim supplicated a second time after the House was built and its people lived around it, after Ishaq who was thirteen years Ismail's junior was bom. This is why at the end of his supplication, Ibrahim said here, &^ , i' iAll the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has given me in old age Ismd'il (Ishmael) and Ishaq (Isaac). Verily, my Lord is indeed the Hearer ofinvocations} (14:39). Allah said next, o' ex ft*' y'je- d) i"...and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day." He (Allah) answered: "Asfor him who disbelieves, I shall leave him in contentment for a while, then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!"} Ibn Jarir said that Ubayy bin KaTa commented on. iHe answered: "As for him who disbelieves, I shall leave him in contentment for a

while, then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!"} "These are Allah's Words (meaning not Ibrahim's)"* 11 This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid and Ikrimah.*21 Furthermore, Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 111 At-Tabari 3 :53. At-Tabari 3:54.

fT~i i** J“ 4»>^' Oi itib W* '-i? 'j!» j**-' 4'-'^ <My Lord, make this city (Makkah) a place of security and provide its people with fruits, such of them as believe in Allah and the Last Day.\$ "Ibrahim asked Allah to grant sustenance for the believers only. However, Allah revealed, 'I will also provide for the disbelievers, just as I shall provide for the believers. Would I create something and not sustain and provide for? I shall allow the disbelievers little delight, and then force them to the torment of the Fire, and what an evil destination." Ibn 'Abbas then recited, & Cj% .i£ ij tfji li 40n each these as well as those We bestow from the bounties of your Lord. And the bounties of your Lord can never be forbidden> (17:20). This was recorded by Ibn Marduwyah, who also recorded similar statements from 'Ikrimah and Mujahid. Similarly, Allah said, C4i JLi ^2% 4 £> V Sj' 4 ljlt£=3C f jil A', iVerily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.\$ (10:69-70), J.U pic -till ol ^1 j-j? —>ljc cl) (Is 4jB 4And whoever disbelieves, let not his disbelief grieve you (O Muliammad To Us is their return, and We shall inform than what they have done. Verily, Allah is the Knower of what is in the breasts (of men). We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment (31:23-24) and, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:377.

j— lili irl LiujJ j\ "^\jj} J£= o}J l»>y.> U/~y& rt'-X^b 'XZX-dk lj& gl»*J / ^ i^ ^ ^ ^ ^ -J # ^ X X ^rs , (j\il*A) cibj JCij * LijJ' U *ijj> 4A»d were it >iof that mankind would have become of one community (all disbelievers desiring worldly life only). We would have provided for those who disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah), silver roofs for their houses, and elevators whereby they ascend. And for their houses, doors (of silver), and thrones (of silver) on which they could recline. And adornments of gold. Yet all this would have been nothing but an enjoyment of this world. And the Hereafter with your Lord is (only) for the Muttaqin (the pious).} (43:33-35). Allah said next, jiiii d) 4Then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination!} meaning, "After the delight that the disbeliever enjoyed in this life, I will make his destination torment in the Fire, and what an evil destination." This Ayah indicates that Allah gives the disbelievers respite and then seizes them in a manner compatible to His greatness and ability. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, 4 ilHi CAj Li hi/ £ \$fo=T)} iAnd many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then (in the end) I seized it (with punishment) And to Me is the (final) return (of all)} (22:48). Also, the Two Sahihs recorded, Xj jt ***** ifo- 'fX H-\ "No one is more patient than Allah when hearing abuse. They attribute a son to Him, while He grants them sustenance and health .»|11 The Sahih. also recorded, (1 ' FathAl-Bari 13:372, and Muslim 4:2160.

386 Tafsir Tbt Kathir j*J aJL»4 lit '^J .»• pJUaJLj 3)1 jl® "Allah gives respite to the unjust person, until when He seizes him; He never lets go of him .»|11 He then recited Allah's statement, IS&&& iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He punishes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe (11:102) Building the Kaltah and asking Allah to

accept This Deed Allah said, j Ot J-t'jiill A*fj S jV Ai4 IJc- w^J \£j& kill -clL-.1 iixJj'i JAJ iitt ijlLli (Ij 4And (remember) when Ibrahim (Abraham) and (his son) Ismd'il (Ishmael) were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knou>er. Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and shoiv us our Mandsik and accept our repentance. Trtdy, You are the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful."4 Allah said, "O Muhammad! Remind your people when Ibrahim and Ismail built the House and raised its foundations while saying, 4jjj\ %& c# iOur Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower."^ Al-Qurtxibi mentioned that Ubayy and Ibn Mas*ud used to recite the Ayah this way, (il Fath Al-Bari 8 :205

> j //^ f | ^ # , tj,«* ^ , /j «# ^^'.J i C-ii <3 J J 'r-W cm *tj r.ii 4Anrf (remember) when Ibrahim and Ohs son) Istnd'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), Saying, "Our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower."} {^ What further testifies to this statement (which adds 'saying' to the Ayah) by Ubayy and Ibn Maslad, is what came afterwards, iOur Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You}. The Prophets Ibrahim and Ismail were performing a good deed, yet they asked Allah to accept this good deed from them. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Wuhayb bin Al-Ward recited, iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim and Ohs son) Ismd'il were raising the foundations of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah), (saying), "Our Lord! Accept (this service)from us"} and cried and said, "O Khalil of Ar-Rahman[You raise the foundations of the House of Ar-Rahman (Allah), yet you are afraid that He will not accept it from you?"]*21 This is the behavior of the sincere believers, whom Allah described in His statement, t oyy • iAnd those who give that which they give} (23:60) meaning, they give away voluntary charity, and perform the acts of worship yet, iwith their hearts full offear} (23:60) 111 Al-Qurtubi 2:126. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :384

388 Tafeir Ibn KatHir afraid that these good deeds might not be accepted of them. There is an authentic Hadith narrated by 'A'ishah on this subject, which we will mention later, Allah willing. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Prophet Ibrahim took Ismail and his mother and went away with them until he reached the area of the House, where he left them next to a tree above Zamzam in the upper area of the Masjid. During that time, Ismail's mother was still nursing him. Makkah was then uninhabited, and there was no water source in it. Ibrahim left them there with a bag containing some dates and a water-skin containing water. Ibrahim then started to leave, and Ismail's mother followed him and said, 'O Ibrahim! To whom are you leaving us in this barren valley that is not inhabited?' She repeated the question several times and Ibrahim did not reply. She asked, Has Allah commanded you to do this?' He said, "Yes.' She said, 1 am satisfied that Allah will never abandon us.' Ibrahim left, and when he was far enough away where they could not see him, close to Thaniyyah, he faced the House, raised his hands and supplicated, 6'i£ Jt oiCJ ti\ TZj} 40 our Lord! I have made some ofmy offspring to dwell in an uncultivable valley by Your Sacred House (the Ka'bah at Makkah)} until, iGive thanks} (14:37). Ismail's mother then returned to her place, started drinking water from the water-skin and nursing Ismail. When the water was used up, she and her son became thirsty. She looked at him, and he was suffering from thirst; she left, because she disliked seeing his face in that condition. She found the nearest mountian to where she was, As-Safa, ascended it and looked, in vain, hoping to see somebody. When she came down to the valley, she raised her garment and ran, just as a tired person runs, until she

reached the Al- Marwah mountain. In vain, she looked to see if there was someone there. She ran to and fro (between the two mountains) seven times.” Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger

389 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) of Allah jg said, “This is why the people make the trip between As-Safa and Al-Marwah (during Hajj and Umrah).” “When she reached Al-Marwah, she heard a voice and said, ‘Shush,’ to herself. She tried to hear the voice again and when she did, she said, ‘I have heard you. Do you have relief?’ She found the angel digging with his heel (or his wing) where Zamzam now exists, and the water gushed out. Ismail’s mother was astonished and started digging, using her hand to transfer water to the water-skin.” Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Prophet jg then said, “May Allah grant His mercy to the mother of Ismail, had she left the water, (flow naturally without her intervention), it would have been flowing on the surface of the earth.” “Ismail’s mother started drinking the water and her milk increased for her child. The angel (Gabriel) said to her, ‘Do not fear abandonment. There shall be a House for Allah built here by this boy and his father. Allah does not abandon His people.’ During that time, the area of the House was raised above ground level and the floods used to reach its right and left sides. Afterwards some people of the tribe of Jurhum, passing through Kada’, made camp at the bottom of the valley. They saw some birds, they were astonished, and said, ‘Birds can only be found at a place where there is water. We did not notice before that this valley had water.’ They sent a scout or two who searched the area, found the water, and returned to inform them about it. Then they all went to Ismail’s mother, next to the water, and said, ‘O Mother of Ismail! Will you allow us to be with you (or dwell with you)?’ She said, “Yes. But you will have no exclusive right to the water here.’ They said, “We agree.” Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Prophet sg said, “At that time, Ismail’s mother liked to have human company.” “And thus they stayed there and sent for their relatives to join them. Later on, her boy reached the age of puberty and married a lady from them, for Ismail learned Arabic from them, and they liked the way he was raised. Ismail’s mother died after that. Then an idea occurred to Abraham to visit his dependents. So he left (to Makkah). When he arrived, he did not find Ismail, so he asked his wife about him. She said, *He has

390 Tafsir Urn Kathir gone out hunting.’ When he asked her about their living conditions, she complained to him that they live in misery and poverty. Abraham said (to her), When your husband comes, convey my greeting and tell him to change the threshold of his gate.’ When Ismail came, he sensed that they had a visitor and asked his wife, ‘Did we have a visitor?’ She said, “Yes. An old man came to visit us and asked me about you, and I told him where you were. He also asked about our condition, and I told him that we live in hardship and poverty.’ Ismail said, ‘Did he ask you to do anything?’ She said, ‘Yes. He asked me to convey his greeting and that you should change the threshold of your gate.’ Ismail said to her, He was my father and you are the threshold, so go to your family (i.e. you are divorced).’ So he divorced her and married another woman. Again Ibrahim thought of visiting his dependents whom he had left (at Makkah). Ibrahim came to Ismail’s house, but did not find Ismail and asked his wife, Where is Ismail?’ Ismail’s wife replied, He has gone out hunting.’ He asked her about their condition, and she said that they have a good life and praised Allah. Ibrahim asked, What is your food and what is your drink?’ She replied, ‘Our food is meat and our drink is water.’ He said, ‘O Allah! Bless their meat and their drink.’” The Prophet (Muhammad jfe) said, “They did not have crops then, otherwise Ibrahim would have invoked Allah to bless that too. Those who do not live in Makkah cannot bear eating a diet only containing meat and water.” “Ibrahim said, When Ismail comes back,

convey my greeting to him and ask him to keep the threshold of his gate.' When Ismail came back, he asked, 'Has anyone visited us.' She said, 'Yes. A good looking old man,' and she praised Ibrahim, 'And he asked me about our livelihood and I told him that we live in good conditions.' He asked, 'Did he ask you to convey any message?' She said, 'Yes. He conveyed his greeting to you and said that you should keep the threshold of your gate.' Ismail said, 'That was my father, and you are the threshold; he commanded me to keep you.' Ibrahim then came back visiting and found Ismail behind the Zamzam well, next to a tree, mending his arrows. When he saw Ibrahim, he stood up and they greeted each other, just as

391 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) the father and son greet each other. Ibrahim said, 'O Ismail, Your Lord has ordered me to do something.' He said, 'Obey your Lord.' He asked Ismail, 'Will you help me?' He said, 'Yes, I will help you.' Ibrahim said, 'Allah has commanded me to build a house for Him there,' and he pointed to an area that was above ground level. So, both of them rose and started to raise the foundations of the House. Abraham started building (the Ka'bah), while Ismail continued handing him the stones. Both of them were saying, 'O our Lord ! Accept (this service) from us, Verily, You are the Hearing, the Knowing.' (2.127).” Hence, they were building the House, part by part, going around it and saying, 'O our Lord! Accept (this service) from us. Verily, You are the Hearer, the Knower.' The Messenger of Allah was sent as Prophet In his Sirah, Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, “When the Messenger of Allah reached thirty-five years of age, the Quraysh gathered to rebuild the Ka'bah, this included covering it with a roof. However, they were weary of demolishing it. During that time, the Ka'bah was barely above a man's shoulder, so they wanted to raise its height and build a ceiling on top. Some people had stolen the Ka'bah's treasure beforehand, which used to be in a well in the middle of the Ka'bah. The treasure was later found with a man called, Duwayk, a freed servant of Bani Mulayh bin 'Amr, from the tribe of Khuza'ah. The Quraysh cut off his hand as punishment. Some people claimed that those who actually stole the treasure left it with Duwayk. Afterwards, the sea brought a ship that belonged to a Roman merchant to the shores of Jeddah, where it washed-up. So they collected the ship's wood to use it for the Ka'bah's ceiling; a Coptic carpenter in Makkah prepared what they needed for the job. When they decided to begin the demolition process to rebuild 111 Fath Al-Bari 6:456.

392 Tafstr Ibn Katlir the House, Abu Wahb bin 'Amr bin 'A'idh bin 'Abd bin Imran bin Makhzum took a stone from the Ka'bah, the stone slipped from his hand and went back to where it had been. He said, 'O people of Quraysh! Do not spend on rebuilding the House, except from what was earned from pure sources. No money earned from a prostitute, usury or injustice should be included.’” Ibn Ishaq commented here that the people also attribute these words to Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah bin 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Makhzum. Ibn Ishaq continued, “The Quraysh began to organize their efforts to rebuild the Ka'bah, each subtribe taking the responsibility of rebuilding a designated part of it. However, they were still weary about bringing down the Ka'bah. Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah said, 'I will start to bring it down.' He held an ax and stood by the Ka'bah and said, 'O Allah! No harm is meant. O Allah! We only seek to do a good service.' He then started to chop the House's stones. The people waited that night and said, 'We will wait and see. If something strikes him, we will not bring it down and instead rebuild it the way it was. If nothing happens to him, then Allah will have agreed to what we are doing.' The next morning, Al-Walid went to work on the Ka'bah, and the people started bringing the Ka'bah

down with him. When they reached the foundations that Ibrahim built, they uncovered green stones that were above each other, just like a pile of spears.” Ibn Ishaq then said that some people told him, “A man from Quraysh, who was helping rebuild the Ka'bah, placed the shovel between two of these stones to pull them up; when one of the stones was moved, all of Makkah shook, so they did not dig up these stones.”¹² The Dispute regarding Who should place the Black Stone in Its Place Ibn Ishaq said, “The tribes of Quraysh collected stones to rebuild the House, each tribe collecting on their own. They started rebuilding it, until the rebuilding of the Ka'bah reached the point where the Black Stone was to be placed in *** Ibn Hisham 1 :204. * Ibn Hisham 1 :207

393 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) its designated site. A dispute erupted between the various tribes of Quraysh, each seeking the honor of placing the Black Stone for their own tribe. The dispute almost led to violence between the leaders of Quraysh in the area of the Sacred House. Banu ‘Abd Ad-Dar and Banu ‘Adi bin Ka'b bin Lu'ay, gave their mutual pledge to fight until death. However, five or four days later, Abu Umayyah bin Al-Mughlah bin ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin Makhzum, the oldest man from Quraysh then intervened at the right moment. Abu Umayyah suggested that Quraysh should appoint the first man to enter the House from its entrance to be a mediator between them. They agreed. The Messenger - Muhammad sg - was the first person to enter the House. When the various leaders of Quraysh realized who the first one was, they all proclaimed, This is Al-Amin (the Honest one). We all accept him; This is Muhammad.’ When the Prophet sg reached the area where the leaders were gathering and they informed him about their dispute, he asked them to bring a garment and place it on the ground. He placed the Black Stone on it. He then requested that each of the leaders of Quraysh hold the garment from one side and all participate in lifting the Black Stone, moving it to its designated area. Next, the Prophet jg carried the Black Stone by himself and placed it in its designated position and built around it. The Quraysh used to call the Messenger of Allah ‘Al-Amin’ even before the revelation came to him.” Ibn Az-Zubayr rebuilds Al-Ka'bah the way the Prophet wished Ibn Ishaq said, “During the time of the Prophet 3g, the Ka'bah was eighteen cubits high and was covered with Egyptian linen, and they with a striped garment. Al-Hajjaj bin Yusuf was the first person to cover it with silk.” ’ The Ka'bah remained the same way the Quraysh rebuilt it, until it was burned during the reign of ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr, after the year 60 H, at the end of the reign of Yazid bin Mu'awiyah. During that time, Ibn Az-Zubayr was besieged at Makkah. When it was burned, Ibn Az-Zubayr brought the Ka'bah down and built it upon the foundations of Ibrahim, including the Hijr m Ibn Hisham 1 :21 1

in it. He also made an eastern door and a western door in the Ka'bah and placed them on ground level. He had heard his aunt ‘A'ishah, the Mother of the believers, narrate that the Messenger of Allah jg had wished that. The Ka'bah remained like this throughout his reign, until Al-Hajjaj killed Ibn Az-Zubayr and then rebuilt it the way it was before, by the order of ‘Abdul-Malik bin Marwan. Muslim recorded that ‘Ata’ said, “The House was burnt during the reign of Yazid bin Mu'awiyah, when the people of Ash-Sham raided Makkah. Ibn Az-Zubayr did not touch the House until the people came for Hajj, for he wanted to incite them against the people of Ash-Sham. He said to them, ‘O people! Advise me regarding the Ka'bah, should we bring it down and rebuild it, or just repair the damage it sustained?’ Ibn ‘Abbas said, I have an opinion about this. You should rebuild the House the way it was when the people became Muslims. You should leave the stones that existed when the people became Muslims and when the Prophet jg was sent.’ Ibn Az-Zubayr said, If the house of one of them gets burned, he will not

be satisfied, until he rebuilds it. How about Allah's House? I will invoke my Lord for three days and will then implement what I decide.' When the three days had passed, he decided to bring the Ka'bah down. The people hesitated to bring it down, fearing that the first person to climb on the House would be struck down. A man went on top of the House and threw some stones down, and when the people saw that no harm touched him, they started doing the same. They brought the House down to ground level. Ibn Az-Zubayr surrounded the site with curtains hanging from pillars, so that the House would be covered, until the building was erect. Ibn Az-Zubayr then said, 'I heard 'A'ishah say that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, 'It is better for the people to bring the House down than to see it destroyed. If it was not for the fact that the people have recently abandoned disbelief, and that I do not have enough money to spend on it, I would have included in the House five cubits

from Al-Hijr and would have made a door for it that people could enter from, and another door that they could exit from. Ibn Az-Zubayr said, 'I can spend on this job, and I do not fear the people.' So he added five cubits from the Hijr, which looked like a rear part for the House that people could clearly see. He then built the House and made it eighteen cubits high. He thought that the House was still short and added ten cubits in the front and built two doors in it, one as an entrance and another as an exit. When Ibn Az-Zubayr was killed, Al-Hajjaj wrote to 'Abdul- Malik bin Marwan asking him about the House and told him that Ibn Az-Zubayr made a rear section for the House. 'Abdul- Malik wrote back, 'We do not agree with Ibn Az-Zubayr's actions. As for the Ka'bah's height, leave it as it is. As for what he added from the Hijr, bring it down, and build the House as it was before and close the door.' Therefore, Al-Hajjaj brought down the House and rebuilt it as it was." * In his Sunan, An-Nasa'i collected the Hadith of the Prophet narrated from 'A'ishah, not the whole story, The correct Sunnah conformed to Ibn Az-Zubayr's actions, because this was what the Prophet wished he could do, but feared that the hearts of the people who recently became Muslim could not bear rebuilding the House. This Sunnah was not clear to 'Abdul-Malik bin Marwan. Hence, when 'Abdul- Malik realized that 'A'ishah had narrated the Hadith of the Messenger of Allah[^] on this subject, he said, "I wish we had left it as Ibn Az-Zubayr had made it." Muslim recorded that 'Ubaydullah bin 'Ubayd said that Al-Harith bin 'Abdullah came to 'Abdul-Malik bin Marwan during his reign. 'Abdul- Malik said, 'I did not think that Abu Khubayb (Ibn Az-Zubayr) heard from 'A'ishah what he said he heard from her.' Al-Harith said, 'Yes he did. I heard the Hadith from her.' 'Abdul-Malik said, 'You heard her say what?' He said, 'She said that the Messenger of Allah said, ijSjj i* jLfijLf*- ljsf u Muslim 2:970. 121 An-Nasa'i 5:218.

‘Your people rebuilt the House smaller. Had it not been for the fact that your people are not far from the time of Shirk, I would add what was left outside of it. If your people afterwards think about rebuilding it, let me show you what they left out of it.’ He showed her around seven cubits.’ One of the narrators of the Hadith, Al-Walid bin ‘Ata’, added that the Prophet said, ‘If I had wanted, I would have made two doors for the House on ground level, one eastern and one western. Do you know why your people raised its door above ground level?’ She said, ‘No.’ He said, ‘To allow only those whom they wanted to enter it. When a man whom they did not wish to enter the House climbed to the level of the door, they would push him down.’ ‘Abdul-Malik then said, ‘You heard ‘A’ishah say this Hadith?’ He said, ‘Yes.’ ‘Abdul-Malik said, ‘I wish I left it as it was.’! An Ethiopian will destroy the Kabbah just before the Last Hour. The Two Sahih recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, ‘The Ka’bah will be destroyed by Dhus-Sawiqatayn (literally, a person with two lean legs) from Ethiopia.’

21 Also, Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Prophet said, Sjl «As if I see him now : a black person with thin legs plucking the stones of the Ka'bah one after another. Al-Bukhari Muslim 2:971. Fath Al-Bari 3 :538 , and Muslim 4 :2232

397 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) recorded this Hadithft^ Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded in his Musnad that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin Al-‘As said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, i Lks’js^jj \ JI jj ‘fck y«*f j £4-^’ «Dltus-Sawiqatayn from Ethiopia will destroy the Ka'bah and will loot its adornments and cover. It is as if I see him now: bald, with thin legs striking the Ka'bah with his ox.»¹²¹ This will occur after the appearance of Gog and Magog people. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, uThere will be Hajj and 'Umrah to the House after the appearance of Gog and Magog people. Al-KhalWs Supplication Allah said that Ibrahim and Ismail supplicated to Him, cJ kill — ‘• llljjj ui.l—1 LLuJj “Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and show us our Mandsik, and accept our repentance. Truly, You are the One Wlw accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.” Ibn Jarir said, “They meant by their supplication, ‘Make us submit to Your command and obedience and not associate anyone with You in obedience or worship.’”⁴ Also, Ikrimah commented on the Ayah, iJ £jLi lliJj Gj} iOur Lord! And make us submissive unto You m Fath Al-Bari 3 :538 •2| Ahmad 2:220. 131 Fath Al-Bari 3 :531. At-Tabari 3 :73

“Allah said, ‘I shall do that.’” iAtid of our offspring a nation submissive unto You} Allah said, ‘I shall do that.’” This supplication by Ibrahim and Ismail is similar to what Allah informed us of about His believing servants, 4;v.:CC\ iAnd those who say : ‘Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes, and make us leaders of the Muttaqin} (25:74). This type of supplication is allowed, because loving to have offspring who worship Allah alone without partners is a sign of complete love of Allah. This is why when Allah said to Ibrahim, JtttC ^} iVerily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind (to folloio you)} Ibrahim said, JC 1 JU ‘tjffj* Lrt-j} i“And of my offspring (to make leaders).” (Alldlt) said, "My covenant (prophethood) includes not the Zalimrn (polytheists and wrongdoers)" which is explained by, }And keep me and my sons away from worshipping idols} Muslim narrated in his Sahih that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jJj ji jjuf jf iiXut y* Vj <JLlp ^Liil ’JA oU Ijl «ij <‘Whe it the son of Adam dies, his deeds end except Jbr three deeds: an ongoing charity, a knowledge that is being benefited from and a righteous son who supplicates (to Allah) for him.^ in Muslim 3 : 1255.

The Meaning of Manasik Said bin Mansur said that ‘Attab bin Bashir informed us from Khaslf, from Mujahid who said, “The Prophet Ibrahim supplicated, iand show us our Manasik^ Jibril then came down, took him to the House and said, ‘Raise its foundations.’ Ibrahim raised the House’s foundations and completed the building. Jibril held Ibrahim’s hand, led him to As-Safa and said, This is among the rituals of Allah.’ He then took him to Al-Marwah and said, ‘And this is among the rituals of Allah.’ He then took him to Mina until when they reached the ‘Aqabah, they found Iblls standing next to a tree. Jibril said, ‘Say Takbir (Allah is the Great) and throw (pebbles) at him.’ Ibrahim said the Takbir and threw (pebbles at) Iblls. Iblls moved to the middle Jamrah, and when Jibril and Ibrahim passed by him, Jibril said to Ibrahim, ‘Say Takbir and throw at him.’ Ibrahim threw at him and said Takbir. The devious Iblls sought to add some evil acts to the rituals of Hajj, but he was unable to succeed. Jibril took

Ibrahim's hand and led him to Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram and 'Arafat and said to him, 'Have you 'Arafta (known, learned) what I showed you?' thrice. Ibrahim said, Yes I did.'",¹ Similar statements were reported from Abu Mijlaz and Qatadah.¹² yti cSM 4129. "Our Lord! Send amongst them a Messenger of their oivtt, who shall recite unto them Your verses and instruct them in the Book (this Qur'an), and purify them. Verily, You are the Mighty, the Wise."⁴ Ibrahim's Supplication that Allah sends the Prophet Allah mentioned Ibrahim's supplication for the benefit of the people of the Sacred Area (to grant them security and Said Bin Man?Qr 2 :615. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :387.

400 Tafstr Ibn Kathir provision), and it was perfected by invoking Allah to send a Messenger from his offspring. This accepted supplication, from Ibrahim, conformed with Allah's appointed destiny that Muhammad be sent as a Messenger among the Ummiyyin and to all non-Arabs, among the Jinns and mankind. Hence, Ibrahim was the first person to mention the Prophet S§ to the people. Ever since, Muhammad jfe was known to the people, until the last Prophet was sent among the Children of Israel, Jesus the son of Mary, who mentioned Muhammad m, by name. Jesus addressed the Children of Israel saying, 41 am the Messenger of Allah tinto you, confirming what is before me in the Tawrah, and giving glad tidings of a Messenger to come after me, ivhose name shall be Ahmad^ (61 :6) This is why the Prophet sfe said , "The supplication of my father Ibrahim and the glad tidings broughtforth by Jesus the son of Mary, »(11 The Prophet% said. "My mother saw a light that went out of her and radiated the palaces of Ash-Sham »'21 It was said that the Prophet's mother saw this vision when she was pregnant with, narrated this vision to her people, and the story became popular among them. The light mentioned in the Hadith appeared in Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), testifying to what will later occur when the Prophet's religion will be firmly established in Ash-Sham area. This is why by the end of time, Ash-Sham will be a refuge for Islam and its people. Also, Jesus the son of Mary will descend in Ash-Sham, next to the eastern white minaret in Damascus. The Two Sahihs stated, As-Sahihah nos.1546 and 1925. (2 > Ahmad 5 :262

401 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) '{till pAj* u»*J j3>l jil uThere will always be a group of my Ummah zoho will be on the truth, undeterred by those who fail or oppose them, until the command of Allah comes while they are on this. Al-Bukhari added in his Sahih, «And they loill reside in Ash- S/ lflmV 1 ' The Meaning of Al-Kitab wal-Hikmah Allah said, iatid instruct them in the Book} meaning, Al-Qur'an, iand Al-Hikmah} meaning, the Sunnah, as Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Abu Malik asserted.¹² It was also said that 'Al-Hikmah\ means 'comprehension in the religion', and both meanings are correct. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said, that Ibn 'Abbas said that, iand purify them} means, "With the obedience of Allah."³ iVerily, You are the Mighty, the W/se^. This Ayah stated that Allah is able to do anything, and nothing escapes His ability. He is Wise in His decisions, His actions, and He puts everything in its rightful place due to His perfect knowledge, wisdom and justice. •jfi' ^ *i'j liill q «v..«lw>' Ju}j ^ yi O*- J*j} f is**}} 3'J 3^33 i ft i "^1 lAyCi C«SI iw>' «j)' Jjyuo} fjb il30. And who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim (i.e. Fath Al-Bari 6 :73 1 and Muslim 2 : 1524 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :390. '3 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :391

Islamic Monotheism) except him who fools himself? Truly, We chose him in this world and verily, in the Hereafter he will be among the righteous}. 4131. When his Lord said to him, "Submit (i.e. be a Muslim)!" He said, "I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the 'Alamin (mankind, Jinn

and all that exists).”} 4132. And this (submission to Allah, Islam) was enjoined by Ibrahim (Abraham) upon his sons and by Ya'qub (Jacob) (saying), “O my sons! Allah has chosen for you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims.”} Only the Fools deviate from Ibrahim’s Religion Allah refuted the disbelievers’ innovations of associating others with Allah in defiance of the religion of Ibrahim, the leader of the upright. Ibrahim always singled out Allah in worship, with sincerity, and he did not call upon others besides Allah. He did not commit Shirk, even for an instant. He disowned every other deity that was being worshipped instead of Allah and defied all his people in this regard. Prophet Ibrahim said, s •+ } * « 31 »iXp> uj 4^-i} 4%<jfjS^ ft Zj 40 my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners (in worship with Allah). Verily, I have turned myface towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth Hanifa (Islamic Monotheism), and I am not of Al-Mushriktn .} (6:78- 79). Also, Allah said, vffoi lijji ^ ^ ,cj i, tL 4And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father and his people: "Verily, I am innocent of what you worship. "Except Him (i.e. I worship none but Allah alone) Who did create me; and verily, He will guide me”} (43 :26-27),

403Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) 4And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he (Ibrahim) had made to him (his father). But when it became clear to him (Ibrahim) that he Otis father) was an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himselffrom him. Verily, Ibrahim was Awivah (one ivho invokes Allah with humility, glorifies Hitti and remembers Him much) and was forbearing} (9:114), and, 4 Verify, Ibrahim ivas an Ummah (a leader having all the good qualities, or a nation), obedient to Allah, Hanif (i.e. to worship none but Allah), and he was not one of those who were Al- Mushrikin. (He was) thankful for His (Allah's) favors. He (Allah) chose him (as an intonate friend) and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.} (16:120-122). This is why Allah said here, ii£ — ^j} 4And who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim}, meaning, abandons his path, way and method Li; J. -jt} 4except him who fools himself} meaning, who commits injustice against himself by deviating from the truth, to wickedness. Such a person will be defying the path of he who was chosen in this life to be a true Imam, from the time he was young, until Allah chose him to be His Khalil, and who shall be among the successful in the Last Life. Is there anything more insane than deviating from this path and following the path of misguidance and deviation instead? Is there more injustice than this? Allah said, 4^L JjJili dJ,} iVerily, joining others in worship with Alldlt is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed} (31:13). Abu Al-‘Aliyah and Qatadah said, “This Ayah (2:130) was revealed about the Jews who invented a practice that did not

come from Allah and that defied the religion of Ibrahim.”^ Allah’s statement. £-1 itX cs ^ & dp «*; st c} %% fee *3sS^ ^ ^ ilbrahim was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifo (to worship none but Allah alone) and he was not ofAl-Mushrikin . Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet (Muhammad jg) and those who have believed (Muslims). And Allah is the Walt (Protector and Helper) of the believers.} (3:67-68), testifies to this fact. Allah said next, 4lf^cjj£S> cJJJ Jis ,’ 4j \$ Ju iWhen his Lord said to him, ",Submit (i.e. be a Muslim)!" He said, "I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the ‘Alamin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists).”} This Ayah indicates that Allah commanded Ibrahim to be sincere with Him and to abide and submit to Him; Ibrahim perfectly adhered to Allah’s command. Allah’s statement, 4And this (submission to Allah, Islam) xvas enjoined by Ibrahim upon his sons and by

Ya'qub} means, Ibrahim commanded his offspring to follow this religion, that is, Islam, for Allah. Or, the Ayah might be referring to Ibrahim's words, 41 have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the 'Alamitt (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)}. This means that these Prophets loved these words so much that they preserved them until the time of death and advised their children to adhere to them after them. Similarly, Allah said, ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :392.

405 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) Part-1) 4 And he (Ibrahim) made it [i.e. La ildha illallah (none has the right to be worshipped but Allah alone)] a Word lasting among his offspring, (true Monotheism)} (43:28). It might be that Ibrahim advised his children, including Jacob, Isaac's son, who were present. It appears, and Allah knows best, that Isaac was endowed with Jacob, during the lifetime of Ibrahim and Sarah, for the good news includes both of them in Allah's statement, J*«-l Ao jtJ -I } But We gave her (Sarah) glad tidings of Isliq (Isaac), and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub (Jacob)} (11:71). Also, if Jacob was not alive then, there would be no use here in mentioning him specifically among Isaac's children. Also, Allah said in Surat Al-'Ankabut, iro* j liLiY JjyUjj S**-0(^rkt)} 4 And We bestowed on him (Ibrahim), Ishaq and Ya'qub, and We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book.} (29:27), and, ^ &a^} } And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and (a grandson) Ya'qub} (21:72), thus, indicating that this occurred during Ibrahim's lifetime. Also, Jacob built Bayt Al-Maqdis, as earlier books testified. The Two Sahih recorded that Abu Dharr said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Which Masjid was built first?' He said, uAl-Masjid Al-Haram (Al-Ka'bah) .» I said, Then?' He said, iBayt Al- Maqdis I said, 'How many years later?' He said, uForty years* 1 Further, the advice that Jacob gave to his children, which we will soon mention, testifies that Jacob was among those who received the advice mentioned in Ayat above (2:ISO- 132). Adhering to Tawhid until Death Allah said, iSyUli ** U& ft &h ' l ' Path Al-Bari 6 :469 , and Muslim 1 :370.

i(Saying), "O my sons! Allah has chosen for you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims meaning, perform righteous deeds during your lifetime find remain on this path, so that Allah will endow you with the favor of dying upon it. Usually, one dies upon the path that he lived on and is resurrected according to what he died on. Allah, the Most Generous, helps those who seek to do good deeds to remain on the righteous path. This by no means contradicts the authentic Hadith that says, VI I f'J Ci Ojfi t, d>dl j^l uj® j0i jaI jii, jud Sp . jilji jii jul j^d 4,1431 4 Jj&l Jinj 1 I dd ji J I £*1, VI 4 i) to «M«n might perform the works of the people of Paradise until only a span of outstretched arms or a cubit separates him from it, then the Book (destiny) takes precedence, and he performs the works of the people of the Fire and thus enters it. Also, man might perform the works of the people of the Fire until only a span of outstretched arms or a cubit separates him from the Fire, but the Book takes precedence and he performs the works of the people of Paradise and thus enters it .t*11 Allah said, (92:5-10), r-A Lr;'.—' GSto- 4As for him who gives (in charity) and keeps his duty to Allah and fears Him. And believes in Al-Husna. We will make smooth for him the path of ease (goodness). But he who is a greedy miser and thinks himself self-sufficient. And belies Al- Husna (none has the right to be worshipped except Allah). We will make smooth for him the path for evil}, Ijlli ifjJu 03-Lid U JIS 4>jtiu Jlii i) iil 'njt,oyli—* \$ if- '^46 CW S-ef 'A'o . "-1 TVI" '.*11 " 111 FathAl-Bari 6:105.

407 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) [yi" U* Vj U c..£ U C+J cJ®. j5 4233. Or were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub (Jacob)? When he said unto his sons, "What will you worship

after me?" They said, "We shall worship your Allah (God - Allah) the Ildh of your fathers, Ibrahim (Abraham), Isma'H (Ishtnael), Ishaq (Isaac), One Halt, and to Him we submit (in Islam))." 4134. That was a nation who has passed away. They shall receive the reward of what they earned and you of what you earn. And you will not be asked of what they used to do.} Ya'qub's Will and Testament to His Children upon His Death This Ayah contains Allah's criticism of the Arab pagans among the offspring of Ismail as well as the disbelievers among the Children of Israel Jacob the son of Isaac, the son of Ibrahim. When death came to Jacob, he advised his children to worship Allah alone without partners. He said to them, 4"What will you worship after me?" They said, "We shall worship your Ildh (God - Allah) the Ildh of your fathers, Ibrahim, Ismd'il, Isfiq," } Mentioning Ismail here is a figure of speech, because Ismail is Jacob's uncle. An-Nahas said that the Arabs call the uncle a father, as Al-Qurtubi mentioned^ This Ayah is used as evidence that the grandfather is called a father and inherits, rather than the brothers (i.e. when his son dies), as Abu Bakr asserted, according to Al-Bukhari who narrated Abu Bakr's statement from Ibn 'Abbas and Ibn Az- Zubayr. Al-Bukhari then commented that there are no opposing opinions regarding this subject.121 This is also the opinion of 'A'ishah the Mother of the believers, Al-Hasan Al- Basri, Tawus and 'Ata', Malik, Ash-Shafi and Ahmad said that 111 Al-Qurtubi 2:138. 121 PathAl-B&ri 12:19.

408 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr the inheritance is divided between the grandfather and the brothers. It was reported that this was also the opinion of 'Umar, 'Uthman, 'Ali, bin Mas*ud, Zayd bin Thabit and several scholars among the Salafand later generations. The statement, 40ne Hah (God)} means, "We single Him out in divinity and do not associate anything or anyone with Him." 4And to Him we submit}, in obedience meaning, obedient and submissiveness. Similarly, Allah said, iWtile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned} (3:83). Indeed, Islam is the religion of all the Prophets, even if their respective laws differed. Allah said, \$ VI% V \$ 4And We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muljammad jgj [but We revealed to him (saying) : La ilaha ilia Ana [none has the right to be ivorshipped but I (Allah)], so ivorship Me (alone and none else)} (21:25). There are many other Ayat - and Hadlths - on this subject. For instance, the Prophet jg said, aL-lj lij ivjl jl x. ^We, the Proplwts, are brothers with different mothers, but the same religion Allah said, js <Z&i} 4That was a nation who has passed away} meaning, existed before your time, m Ahmad 2 :319.

4 l2 £3)££ U } iThey shall receive the reward of what they earned and you of what you earn}. This Ayah proclaims, Your relationship to the Prophets or righteous people among your ancestors will not benefit you, unless you perform good deeds that bring about you religious benefit. They have their deeds and you have yours, 4And you will not be asked of what they used to do}." This is why a Hadith proclaims, w 4j *JlLp 4j Uaj ^Whoever was slowed on account of his deeds will not get any faster on account of his family lineage. u it £ iL^ && % s: ji te yjk. wj} 4135. And they say, "Be Jews or Christians, then you will be guided." Say (to them O Muhammad j&), "Nay, (toe follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanif (Islamic Monotheism), and he was not of Al-Mushrikin (those wlv worshipped others along with Allah.) Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that 'Abdullah bin Suriya Al-A*war said to the Messenger of Allah, "The guidance is only what we (Jews) follow. Therefore, follow us, O Muhammad, and you will be rightly guided." Also, the Christians said similarly, so Allah revealed, 4 L>

'Sji 4And thou say, "Be Jews or Christians, then you will be guided."}'2^ Allah's statement, % S. 111 Muslim 4 :2074 IbnAbiHatim 1:397.

4Say (to them O Muhammad sg), "Nay, (we follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifo means, "We do not need the Judaism or Christianity that you call us to, rather, i(we follow) only the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifo meaning, on the straight path, as Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and 'Isa bin Jariyah stated. 111 Also, Abu Qilabah said, "The Ilanif is what the Messengers, from beginning to end, believed in."121 ty Jrf&b \$ fcj 4136. Say (O Muslims) : "We believe in Allah and that which has been sent down to us and that which has been sent down to Ibrahim (Abraham), Ismd'il (Ishmael), Ishaq (Isaac), Ya'qub (Jacob), and to Al-Asbat (the offspring of the twelve sons of Ya'qub), and that which has been given to Musa (Moses) and 'Isa (Jesus), and that which has been given to the Prophetsfrom their Lord. We make no distinction between any of them, and to Him we have submitted (in Islam) . mm ^ t \ ^ Oo vy. bt jjid •-*» 4jili Js (JjA-le- js ds '->>#> Ijj^XLJ-V'3 cAf * >4Jj # vJj* uj * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :397. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :397

The Muslim believes in all that Allah Revealed and all the Prophets Allah directed His believing servants to believe in what He sent down to them through His Messenger Muhammad jg and in what was revealed to the previous Prophets in general. Some Prophets Allah mentioned by name, while He did not mention the names of many others. Allah directed the believers to refrain from differentiating between the Prophets and to believe in them all. They should avoid imitating whomever Allah described as, us-* O' < \ >' •-* jfi 2 '. . > •* v * Z'r o^i&l jv* tUl'i 'jiiJo jl wis/i to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers (by believing in Allah and disbelieving in His Messengers) saying, "We believe in some but reject others," and xvish to adopt a way in between. They are in truth disbelievers (4:150-151). Al-Bukhari narrated that Abu Hurayrah said, "The People of the Book used to read the Torah in Hebrew and translate it into Arabic for the Muslims. The Messenger of Allah jg said, «0| uj «ii& Ajjiij ij Jit 'jisc •Do not believe the People of the Book, nor reject what they say. Rather, say, We believe in Allah and in what was setit down to hs .»"* 11 Also, Muslim, Abu Dawud and An-Nasal recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Mostly, the Messenger of Allah jg used to recite, 4i4\ Ty it 4We believe in Allah and that which has been sent down to us} (2:136), and, \li it 4We believe in Allah, and bear witness that we are Muslims (i.e. we submit to Allah)} (3:52) during the two (voluntary) nr Fath Al-Bari 8 :20

412 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Rak'dt before Fq/r." Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabi' and Qatadah said, "Al-Asbat are the twelve sons of Jacob, and each one of them had an Ummah of people from his descendants. This is why they were called Al- Asbat."2 ' Al-Khal'l bin Ahmad and others said, "Al-Asbat among the Children of Israel are just like the tribes among the Children of Ismail." This means that the Asbat are the various tribes of the Children of Israel, among whom Allah sent several Prophets. Moses said to the Children of Israel, fd 'Ei ij # iRemember the favor ofAllah to you : when He made Prophets among you, made you kings} (5:20). Also, Allah said, 4U>C-^ \ 'ji iAnd We divided them into twelve tribes} (7:160). Al-Qurtubi said, "Sibt is the group of people or a tribe all belonging to the same ancestors. "3' Qatadah said, "Allah commanded the believers to believe in Him and in all His Books and Messengers."4 ' Also, Sulayman bin Habib said, "We were commanded to believe in the (original) Torah and Injll, but not to implement them."5 jbj 4l)l J j pA UJi jjs .i, It 4137. So if they believe in the

like of that which you believe then they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, then they are only in opposition. So Allah will suffice for you against them. And He is the Hearer, the Knower.} 4133. [Our Sibghah (religion) is] the Sibghah of Allah (Islam) and which Sibghah can be better than Alldh's? And we are His worshippers.} ** Muslim 1 :502 , Abu Dawud 2 :46 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :339 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :399. 131 Al-Qurtubi 2:141. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :400 > Ibid.

413 Surah 2. Al-Baarah (125 - 149) (Part-1 Allah said, if they, the disbelievers among the People of the Book and other disbelievers, believe in all of Allah's Books and Messengers and do not differentiate between any of them, 4 \xi\ 4 then they are rightly guided meaning, they would acquire the truth and be directed to it. 4 but if they turn away from truth to falsehood after proof had been presented to them, 4 ^ (1\$) 4 then they are only in opposition. So Allah will suffice you against them) meaning, Allah will aid the believers against them, 4 And He is the Hearer, the Knower Allah said, 4 The Sibghah of Allah). Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "The religion of Allah. ' This Tafsir was also reported of Mujahid, Abu Al-'Aliyah, 'Ikrimah, Ibrahim, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, 'Abdullah bin Kathir, 'Atiyah Al- 'Awfi, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, As-Suddi and other scholars.*2 The Ayah, 4 Allah's Fitrah (i.e. Allah's Islamic Monotheism)) (30:30) directs Muslims to, "Hold to it." 2&P& pj uj M j ejzs £) ji j' Ijj* \jfc Q Sjjj IA Sih # «£^ Zr oU jS0 s-s & \pp Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :402. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :403

4139. Say (O Muhammad jfe to the Jews and Christians), "Dispute you with us about Allah while He is our Lord and your Lord? And we are to be rewarded for our deeds and you for your deeds. And we are sincere to Him (i.e. we worship Him alone and none else, and we obey His orders)."} 4140. Or say you tlm Ibrahim, Ismail, Ishaq, Ya'qub and Al- Asbdt, were Jews or Christians? Say, "Do you know better or does Allah? And who is more unjust than he who conceals the testimony he has from Allah? And Allah is not unaware of what you do."} 4141. That loas a nation zoho has passed away. They shall receive the reward of what they earned, and you of what you earn. And you will not be asked of what they used to do.} Allah directed His Prophet to pre-empt the arguments with the idolators: 4\$ 4 \$) 4 Say (O Muhammad ag to the Jews and Christians), "Dispute you xvith us about Allah} meaning, "Do you dispute with us regarding the Oneness of Allah, obedience and submission to Him and in avoiding His prohibitions, WJ Jr*JT 4 whilc He is our Lord and your Lord?} meaning, He has full control over us and you, and deserves the worship alone without partners. 4fiuf\ fij T3j> 4 And we are to be rewarded for our deeds and you for your deeds.} meaning, we disown you and what you worship, just as you disown us. Allah said in another Ayah, 4 And if they belie you, say : "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent ofzwhat you do!"} (10:41), and,

415 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-1) 4\$o if they dispute with you (Muhammad sg) say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those who follozo me") (3:20). Allah said about Ibrahim, j js iHis people disputed with him. He said: "Do you dispute with me concerning Allah") (6:80), and, 4 I? j) ^4 i/oh ho/ looked at him toho disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord (Allah?) (2:258). He said in this honorable Ayah, 4 And we are to be rewarded for our deeds azid you for your deeds. And we are sincere to Him .) meaning, "We disown you just as you disown us," 4^4 ;i 4 And we are sincere to Him), in worship and submission. Allah then criticized them in the claim that Ibrahim, the Prophets who came after him and the Asbat were following their religion, whether Judaism or Christianity. Allah said, f pk 4 Say, "Do you know better or does Allah?") meaning, Allah has the best

knowledge and He stated that they were neither Jews, nor Christians. Similarly, Allah said in the Ayah, Ibrahim was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifa (to worship none but Allah alone) and he was the follower of Al-Mushrikun (3:67) and the following Ayat. Allah also said, 4And who is more unjust than he who conceals the testimony he has from Allah? (2:140). Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "They used to recite the Book of Allah He sent to them that stated that the true religion is Islam and that Muhammad is the Messenger

of Allah. Their Book also stated that Ibrahim, Ismail, Ishaq, Ya'qub and the tribes were neither Jews, nor Christians. They testified to these facts, yet hid them from the people. Allah's statement, ii' iAnd Allah is not unaware of what you do\$, is a threat and a warning that His knowledge encompasses every one's deeds, and He shall award each accordingly. Allah then said, Is it that was a nation who has passed away meaning, existed before you, i) that they shall receive the reward of what they earned, and you of what you earn. \$ meaning, they bear their deeds while you bear yours, iAnd you will not be asked of what they used to do) meaning, the fact that you are their relatives will not suffice, unless you imitate their good deeds. Further, do not be deceived by the fact that you are their descendants, unless you imitate them in obeying Allah's orders and following His Messengers who were sent as warners and bearers of good news. Indeed, whoever disbelieves in even one Prophet, will have disbelieved in all the Messengers, especially if one disbelieves in the master and Final Messenger from Allah, the Lord of the worlds, to all mankind and the Jinns. May Allah's peace and blessings be on Muhammad and the rest of Allah's Prophets.

Jill -oj j* Lf. J'f- jSs^? dl (> tJt: jfcK; d}Sg E^ u^j isi Ji^2c Utj. L) l-i- 4 *- eE * jtfa, Eir V*t^1 E*+?. 4>*v y> E VJUp *# o^j E^waJ o^" C*J iEjjh ijij ojldlt^ <<,[fts&i 4142. The fools (idolators hypocrites, and Jews) among the people will say: "What has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah [prayer direction (towards Jerusalem)] to which they used to face in prayer" Say (O Muhammad sg): "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way."} 4143 . Thus We have made you [true Muslims — real believers of Islamic Monotheism, true followers of Prophet Muhammad M and his Sunnah (legal ways)], a Wasat (just and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad 3g) be a witness over you. And We made the Qiblah which you used to face, only to test those who followed the Messenger (Muhammad from those who would turn on their heels (i.e., disobey the Messenger). Indeed it was great (heavy, difficult) except for those whom Allah guided. And y mm tt -asp ^ <oSJa LfrXk- \jjfo==ai jpsili-dil'jSj oA^\fi)i<E,1 Sifaj4Si\iSZk cEJi_U (jip JjioiilUj o1 ti>j1 _y>jl ujl.».«_)U!c- dUli ijijjUAjC ^—*0 [j*p-* jt yja*} 0 <U;JitriU

4 Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face towards the heaven. Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that shall please you, so turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah). (2:144) A man from among the Muslims then said, "We wish we could know about those among us who died before the Qiblah was changed (i.e., towards Makkah) and also about our own prayers, that we had performed towards Bayt Al-Maqdis." Allah then revealed: 4And Allah would never make your faith (prayers) to be lost. (2:143) The fools among the people, meaning the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), said, "What made them change the former Qiblah that they used to face?" Allah then revealed: 4The fools (idolators, hypocrites, and Jews) among the people

will say... until the end of the Ayah.]] ‘Ali bin Abu Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said: When Allah’s Messenger jg migrated to Al-Madlnah, Allah commanded him to face Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem). The Jews were delighted then. Allah’s Messenger jfe faced Jerusalem for over ten months. However, he liked (to offer prayer in the direction of) Prophet Ibrahim’s Qiblah (the Ka’bah in Makkah) and used to supplicate to Allah and kept looking up to the sky (awaiting Allah’s command in this regard). Allah then revealed: 4&&& 4turn yourfaces (in prayer) in that direction meaning, its direction. The Jews did not like this change and said, “What made them change the Qiblah that they used to face (meaning Jerusalem)?” Allah revealed: Al-Qurtubi 3:133.

iSay (O Muhammad : "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way There are several other Ahadith on this subject. In summary, Allah’s Messenger sg was commanded to face Bayt Al-Maqdis (during the prayer) and he used to offer prayer towards it in Makkah between the two comers (of Ka’bah), so that the Ka’bah would be between him and Bayt Al-Maqdis8. When the Prophet jg migrated to Al-Madinah, this practice was no longer possible; then Allah commanded him to offer prayer towards Bayt Al-Maqdis, as Ibn Abbas and the majority of the scholars have stated. Al-Bukhari reported in his Sahih that the news (of the change of Qiblah) was conveyed to some of the Ansar while they were performing the ‘Asr (Afternoon) prayer towards Bayt Al-Maqdis, upon hearing that, they immediately changed their direction and faced the Ka’bah . It is reported in the Sahihayn (Al-Bukhari & Muslim) that Ibn ‘Umar narrated: While the people were in Quba’ (Mosque) performing the Fajr (Dawn) prayer, a man came and said, “A (part of the) Qur’an was revealed tonight to Allah’s Messenger jg and he was commanded to face the Ka’bah. Therefore, face the Ka’bah. They were facing Ash-Sham, so they turned towards the Ka’bahP These Hadiths prove that the Nasikh (a Text that abrogates a previous Text) only applies after one acquires knowledge of it, even if the Nasikh had already been revealed and announced. This is why the Companions mentioned above were not commanded to repeat the previous ‘Asr, Maghrib and ‘Isha’ prayers (although they had prayed them towards Jerusalem after Allah had changed the Qiblah). Allah knows best. When the change of Qiblah (to Ka’bah in Makkah) occurred, those inflicted with hypocrisy and mistrust, and the disbelieving Jews, both were led astray from the right guidance and fell into confusion. They said: 9?&*& u> 111 At-Tabari 3:138. I2 ' Al-Bukhari no. 399. These people were from the tribe of Banu Salamah Fath Al-B&ri 8 :24 , and Muslim 1 :375

421Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) iWhat has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah to which they used toface in prayer. ^ They asked, “What is the matter with these people (Muslims) who one time face this direction (Jerusalem), and then face that direction (Makkah)?” Allah answered their questions when He stated: iSay (O Muliammad jg); "To Allah belong both, east and the west meaning, the command, the decision and the authority are for Allah Alone. Hence: 4 ...so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah (and He is High above, over His Throne).} (2:115), and: 4?*^ J** ie jf l\$ j \jy o' 'Jf Jj’4 4 It is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness) that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers); but Al-Birr is the one who believes in Allah.} (2:177) This statement means, the best act is to adhere to Allah’s commands. Hence, wherever He commands us to face, we should face. Also, since obedience requires implementing Allah’s commands, if He commands us every day to face different places, we are His servants and under His disposal, and we face whatever He orders us to face. Certainly, Allah’s care and kindness towards His servant and Messenger,

Muhammad *sg*, and certainly, his Ummah (Muslim nation) is profoundly great. Allah has guided them to the Qiblah of (Prophet) Ibrahim - Allah's Khalil (intimate friend). He has commanded them to face the Ka'bah, the most honorable house (of worship) on the face of the earth, which was built by Ibrahim Al-Khalil in the Name of Allah, the One without a partner. This is why Allah said afterwards:

iSay (O Muhammad *tg*) : "To Allah belong both, east and the west. He guides whom He wills to the straight way ") Imam Ahmad reported that 'A'ishah (the Prophet's wife) said that Allah's Messenger *tg* said about the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians): *U>- l5J}S l_JUj t#J ill Ulil l iiliJl 14^ Ijbi* "They do not envy us for a matter more than they envy us for Jumu'ah (Friday) to which Allah has guided us and from which they were led astray; for the (true) Qiblah to which Allah has directed us and from which they were led astray ; and for our saying 'Amin' behind the Imam (leader of the prayer) .»•• The Virtues of Muhammad's Nation Allah said: *<K£ u£j liip&r4m i*Thus We have made you [true Muslims], a Wasat (just) (and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad *tg*) be a witness over you.) Allah stated that He has changed our Qiblah to the Qiblah of Ibrahim and chose it for us so that He makes us the best nation ever. Hence, we will be the witnesses over the nations on the Day of Resurrection, for all of them will then agree concerning our virtue. The word Wasat in the Ayah means the best and the most honored. Therefore, saying that (the Prophet's tribe) Quraysh is in the Wasat regarding Arab tribes and their areas, means the best. Similarly, saying that Allah's Messenger was in the Wasat of his people, means he was from the best subtribe. Also, 'Asr, the prayer that is described as Wusfa' (a variation of the word Wasat), means the best prayer, as the authentic collections of Ahadith reported. Since Allah made this Ummah (Muslim nation) the Wasaf, He has endowed her with the most complete legislation, the best *m Ahmad 6 :134*.

423 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) Manhaj (way, method, etc.,) and the clearest Madhhab (methodology, mannerism, etc). Allah said: *pi % e* is 4 Cj & il\$%£ VPp P& 'op,&£ 35« 4*He has chosen you (to convey His Message of Islamic Monotheism to mankind), and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship : it is the religion of your father Ibrahim . It is He (Allah) Who has named you Muslims both before and in this (the Qur'an), that the Messenger (Muhammad may be a witness over you and you be witnesses over mankind!) (22:78) Moreover, Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Said narrated: Allah's Messenger said: *JU& : JyCi Ji : i) J12\$ Yfi iJLLa Uijl bj jtft jA UII t# \ofjA*s : 4jji JjjJi J li i<cja)j JUj^a ! ?^lij JLfrjJ JlfraJ £^Jlj *J jj 1 r' — * (jJ&JC3 l JjL*JI i-a 'ji 1_) : diS «Nh/i zai//* be called on the Day of Resurrection and will be asked, 'Have you conveyed (the Message)?' He *zwill* say, 'Yes.' His people *zwill* be summoned and asked, 'Has Nuh conveyed (the Message) to you?' They *zwill* say, 'No *z*vamer came to us and no one (Prophet) *zoas* sent to us.' Niih *zwill* be asked, 'Who testifies for you?' He *zwill* say, 'Muhammad and his Ummah.' » This is why Allah said: *i*Thus We have made you a Wasat nation. 4 The Prophet *sg* said; "The Wasat means the 'Adi (just). You *zwill* be summoned to testify that Niih has conveyed (his Message), and 1 *zwill* attest to your testimonyV It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah. 121 111 Ahmad 3:32. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :21, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :297, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :292 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1432

424 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir Imam Ahmad also reported that Abu Said Khudri narrated: Allah's Messenger *sfe* said: *Ja :JUj ilJj fsJj *ju>j 1 ^ :JISj i'pM :J cJJu : iJ JUj N :bfyii Jliil; Ua ^ Jlili icifj JuAi J^-4* i«s5fj*

ju>»i ?»iU ji U^>li LLj U*b*- : :jUu» Vap :JIS <U£j isi y <Sji JJi il>fc ji Ji^l 4'W.^ 6&J ^Vjit£ ;T^ii^j U^j isi jte e)\$g> «T7ie Prophet would come on the Day of Resurrection with two or more people (his only following!), and his people would also be summoned and asked, 'Has he (their Prophet) conveyed (the Message) to you?' They would say, 'No.' He would be asked, 'Have you conveyed (the Message) to your people?' He would say, 'Yes.' He would be asked, 'Who testifies for you?' He would say, 'Muhammad and his Ummah.' Muhammad and his Ummah would then be summoned and asked, 'Has he conveyed (the Message) to his people?' They would say, 'Yes.' They would be asked, 'Who told you that?' They would say, 'Our Prophet (Muhammad) came to us and told us that the Messengers have conveyed (their Messages) Hence Allah's statement: iThus We have made you a Wasat nation. He said, "(meaning) the 'Adi, ' (he then continued reciting the Ayah): ^ £ tC£ ulij&p&r Sam iThus We have made you, a just (and the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger (Muhammad ig) be a witness over you.y li) Furthermore, Imam Ahmad reported that Abul-Aswad narrated: I came to Al-Madinah and found that an epidemic had broken out that caused many fatalities. I sat next to m Ahmad 3 :58.

425 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) 'Umar bin Al-Khattab once when a funeral procession started and the people praised the dead person. "Umar said, "Wajabat (it will be recorded as such), Wajabati" Then another funeral was brought forth and the people criticized the dead person. Again, TJmar said, "Wajabat." Abul-Aswad asked, "What is Wajabat, O Leader of the faithful?" He said, "I said just like Allah's Messenger jg had said: :Jli hJuu : Jli iLjl aJ 1 IXjU «Arty Muslim for whom four testify that he was righteous, then Allah will enter him into Paradise.' We said, 'Wluit about three?' He said, 'And three.' We said, 'And two?' He said, 'And two.' We did not ask him about (the testimony) of one (believing) person .»" 11 This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, At-Tirmidhi, and An- Nasa'i. The Wisdom behind changing the Qiblah Allah then said: OIJ 'll KM iAnd We made the Qiblah (prayer direction towards Jerusalem) which you used to face, only to test those who followed the Messenger (Muhammad jg) from those who ivould turn on their heels (i.e., disobey the Messenger). Indeed it was great (heavy, difficult) exceptfor those whom Allah guided> Allah states thus: We have legislated for you, O Muhammad, facing Bayt Al-Maqdis at first and then changed it to the Ka'bah so as to find who will follow and obey you and thus face whatever you face. 4 ...from those who would turn on their heels. 111 Ahmad 1:21. * Fath Al-Bari 3 :27 1 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi4 :166 , and An-Nasa'i 4:51.

meaning, reverts from his religion. [Allah then said:] ilndeed it was great (heavy, difficult)} The Ayah indicates that changing the Qiblah from Bayt Al- Maqdis to the Ka'bah is heavy on the heart, except for whomever Allah has rightly guided their hearts, who believe in the truth of the Messenger jfe with certainty and that whatever he was sent with is the truth without doubt. It is they who believe that Allah does what He wills, decides what He wills, commands His servants with what He wills, abrogates any of His commands that He wills, and that He has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof in all this. (The attitude of the believers in this respect is) unlike those who have a disease in their hearts, to whom whenever a matter occurs, it causes doubts, just as this same matter adds faith and certainty to the believers. Similarly, Allah said: I <<3 & kj Ztj plaS jjj J di pT ,!> 4 }And whenever there comes down a Surah (chapter from the Qur'an), some of them (hypocrites) say: "Which ofyou has had his faith increased by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased theirfaith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease (ofdoubt, disbeliefand hypocrisy), it will add doubt and disbelief to their

doubt and disbelief; and they die while they are disbelievers.} (9:124, 125) and: OfcSjtf 4t>' vj 5oj ?'•" »r<, " .'''trf vrt'x iAnd We send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe, and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.} (17:82) Certainly, those who remained faithful to the Messenger jg, obeyed him and faced whatever Allah commanded them, without doubt or hesitation, were the leaders of the Companions. Some scholars stated that the Early Migrants

427Siirah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) (who migrated with the Prophet sis from Makkah to Al-Madlnah) and Ansar (the residents of Al-Madlnah who gave aid and refuge to both the Prophet s§ and the Migrants) were those who offered prayers towards the two Qiblah (Bayt Al-Maqdis and then the Ka'bah). Al-Bukhari reported in the explanation of the Ayah (2:143) that Ibn Umar narrated: While the people were performing the Fajr (Dawn) prayer in the Quba' Mosque, a man came and said, "Qur'an was revealed to the Prophet and he was ordered to face the Ka'bah. Therefore, face the Ka'bah." They then faced the Ka'bahJ ' Muslim also recorded it. At-Tirmidhi added that they were performing Ruku' (bowing down in prayer), and then changed the direction (of the Qiblah) to the Ka'bah while still bowing down.*3 ' Muslim reported this last narration from Anas.'4 ' These Hadiths all indicate the perfect obedience the Companions had for Allah and His Messenger and their compliance with Allah's commandments, may Allah be pleased with them all. Allah said: iAnd Allah would never make yourfaith (prayers) to be lost.} meaning, the reward of your prayers towards Bayt Al-Maqdis before would not be lost with Allah. It is reported in Sahih that Abu Ishaq As-Sabi*y related that Bara' narrated: "The people asked about the matter of those who offered prayers towards Bayt Al-Maqdis and died (before the Qiblah was changed to Ka'bah). Allah revealed: if&Li) ^ S'? iAnd Allah would never make yourfaith (prayers) to be lost.}" It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi from Ibn 'Abbas, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahih.'5 ' Ibn Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas narrated: 111 Path Al-Bari 8:22. ' Muslim 1 :375 ' Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :300 141 Muslim 1 :375 ,S| Fath Al-Bari 8 :20 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :300

iAnd Allah would never make yourfaith to be lost> entails: Your (prayer towards) the first Qiblah and your believing your Prophet and obeying him by facing the second Qiblah; He will grant you the rewards for all these acts. Indeed, ccllIt a>t iTruly, Allah is full of kindness, the Most Merciful towards mankind.yW Furthermore, it is reported in the Sahlh that Allah's Messenger saw a woman among the captives who was separated from her child. Whenever she found a boy (infant) among the captives, she would hold him close to her chest, as she was looking for her boy. When she found her child, she embraced him and gave him her breast to nurse. Allah's Messenger jg said: n' : ijiii y M ji. jjz jii * ^ BALm j^j' 40 40 ljS ® ! JG . *jj I J "Do you think that this woman would willingly throw her son in the fire?» They said, "No, O Messenger of Allah!" He said, "By Allah! Allah is more merciful with His servants than this woman with her son.»(21 jy *•»" Jjt I4 .'Yt' j m iSsm iff c<i;& faz pijZ ij> 2% u ixj 'gai iif lij il44. Verily, We have seen the turning ofyour (Muhammad's) face towards the heaven . Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that slmll please you, so turn yourface in the direction ofAl-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah). And wheresoever you people are, turn your faces (in prayer) in that direction. Certainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., Jews 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :99. Muslim 4:2109.

429 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) and Christians) know well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what they do}. The First Abrogation in the Qur'an was about the Qiblah 'Ali bin Abu Talhah related that Ibn 'Abbas narrated: The first abrogated part in the Qur'an was about the Qiblah. When Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) migrated to Al-Madinah, the majority of its people were Jews, and Allah commanded him to face Bayt Al-Maqdis. The Jews were delighted then. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) faced it for ten and some months, but he liked to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim (Ka'bah in Makkah). He used to supplicate to Allah and look up to the sky (awaiting Allah's command). Allah then revealed: 4 AfLj £& lift i Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face towards the heaven}, until, itum your faces (in prayer) in that direction. } The Jews did not like this ruling and said: Ai i#\$pi *& i "What has turned them (Muslims) from their Qiblah (prayer direction) to which they used to face in prayer." Say (O Muhammad), "To Allah belong both, east and the zvest."} (2: 142) Allah said: 'jlyCp} i...so wherever you turn (yourselves or your faces) there is the Face of Allah} (2:115), and: } And We made the Qiblah (prayer direction towards Jerusalem) 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :103.

zohicli you used to face, only to test those who fbllozved the Messenger (Muhammad \$g) from those ivho would turn on their heels (i.e., disobey the Messenger).} (2:143) Is the Qiblah the Ka'bah itself for its General Direction? Al-Hakim related that 'Ali bin Abu Talib said: 4 ...so turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah).} means its direction."11 ' Al-Hakim then commented that the chain of this narration is authentic and that they (i.e., Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not include it in their collections. This ruling concerning the Qiblah is also the opinion of Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and others.'2' Allah's Statement: 4 And wheresoever you people are, turn your faces (in prayer) in that direction \$ is a command from Allah to face the Ka'bah from wherever one is on the earth: the east, west, north or south. The exception is of the voluntary prayer {Nafl) while one is traveling, for one is allowed to offer it in any direction his body is facing, while his heart is intending the Ka'bah. Also, when the battle is raging, one is allowed to offer prayer, however he is able. Also, included are those who are not sure of the direction and offer prayer in the wrong direction, thinking that it is the direction of the Qiblah, because Allah does not burden a soul beyond what it can bear. The Jews had Knowledge that the (Muslim) Qiblah would later be changed Allah stated that: "" Al-Mustadrak 2 :269 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:107-109.

431 Siirah 2 . Al-Baqarah (125 - 149) (Part-2) ^Certainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., Jews and the Christians) know well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. } This Ayah means: The Jews, who did not like that you change your Qiblah from Bayt Al-Maqdis, already knew that Allah will command you (O Muhammad) to face the Ka'bah. The Jews read in their Books their Prophets' description of Allah's Messenger and his Ummah, and that Allah has endowed and honored him with the complete and honorable legislation. Yet, the People of the Book deny these facts because of their envy, disbelief and rebellion. This is why Allah threatened them when He said: ui jii *j} • " } And Allah is not unaware of what they do.} Lj ctlSlj [)A^j U ij» uf |»LJ' 4 lii »f &Sj Ja* ijj gjj. 4245. And even i/ you were to bring to the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) all the Aydt (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.), they ivould not follow your Qiblah (prayer direction), nor are you going to follow their Qiblah. And they will not folloiv each other's Qiblah. Verily, if you folloiv their desires after that which you have

received of knowledge (from Allah), then indeed you will be one of the wrongdoers.} The Stubbornness and Disbelief of the Jews Allah describes the Jews' disbelief, stubbornness and defiance of what they know of the truth of Allah's Messenger jg, that if the Prophet jg brought forward every proof to the truth of what he was sent with, they will never obey him or abandon following their desires. In another instance, Allah said:

Truhj, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96, 97) This is why Allah said here: iyji hf& ia&i yS u 4And even if you were to bring to the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) all the Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.), they would not follow your Qiblah (prayer direction)}. Allah's statement: 4 . . .nor are you going to follow their Qiblah \$>, indicates the vigor with which Allah's Messenger jg implements what Allah commanded him. Allah's statement also indicates that as much as the Jews adhere to their opinions and desires, the Prophet sg adheres by Allah's commands, obeying Him and following what pleases Him, and that he would never adhere to their desires in any case. Hence, praying towards Bayt Al-Maqdis was not because it was the Qiblah of the Jews, but because Allah had commanded it. Allah then warns those who knowingly defy the truth, because the proof against those who know is stronger than against other people. This is why Allah said to His Messenger jg and his Ummah: ^ ms& Tr * m* • * - \+ t .0)1 CJ&.jIP&ss^XmjpkasaiSyj

13 JLUF^ li\Zr U 4 Verily, if you follow their desires after that which you have received of knowledge (from Allah), then indeed you will be one of the wrongdoers.} |Uj j^4-i^ '-2" ^ , 'V {j* Vi O'i 4146. Tthose to whom We gave the Scripture (Jews and Christians) recognise him (Muhammad sg or the Ka'bah at Makkah) as they recognize their sons. But verily, a party of them conceal the truth while they know it - [i.e., the qualities of Muhammad ig which are written in the Tazvrah and the Injil]. 4147. This is) the truth from your Lord. So be you not one of those who doubt}. The Jews know that the Prophet sfe is True, but they hide the Truth Allah states that the scholars of the People of the Scripture know the truth of what Allah's Messenger sg was sent with, just as one of them knows his own child, which is a parable that the Arabs use to describe what is very apparent. Similarly, in a Hadith, Allah's Messenger jg said to a man who had a youngster with him: Aj AJJ l (J) U a i . J ^ ^ IJU i , * < L < 1 ® “/s this your son?» He said, “Yes, O Messenger of Allah! I testify to this fact.” Allah's Messenger jg said: «a1Ip j-yj Yj villi* Y <>\ lit® «Well, you would not transgress against him nor would he transgress against According to Al-Qurtubi, it was narrated that ‘Umar said to ‘Abdullah bin Salam (an Israelite scholar who became a Muslim), “Do you recognize Muhammad as you recognize your 111 Ahmad 4:163.

own son?” He replied, “Yes, and even more. The Honest One descended from heaven on the Honest One on the earth with his (i.e., Muhammad's) description and I recognized him, although I do not know anything about his mother's story.” Allah states next that although they had knowledge and certainty in the Prophet sg, they still: 4>conceal the truth.} The Ayah indicates that they hide the truth from the people, about the Prophet 3\$, that they find in their Books, ids&i fa} iwhile they know it.} Allah then strengthens the resolve of His Prophet ag and the believers and affirms that what the Prophet jg came with is the truth without doubt, saying: £ Cri {ft 4(Ttis is) the truth from your Lord. So be you not one

of those who doubt.} S jfc* ot: ij,jG u 4? 4148. For every nation there is a direction to which they face (in their prayers). So hasten to wards all that is good. Wheresoever you may be, Allah will bring you together (on the Day of Resurrection). Truly, Allah is able to do all things.} Every Nation has a Qiblah Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: 4For every nation there is a direction to which they face (in their prayers)} “This talks about followers of the various religions. Hence, every nation and tribe has its own Qiblah that they choose, Al-Qurtubi 2 :163

435 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) while Allah’s appointed Qiblah is what the believers face. ”I’ 1 Abul-‘Aliyah said, “The Jew has a direction to which he faces (in the prayer). The Christian has a direction to which he faces. Allah has guided you, O (Muslim) Ummah, to a Qiblah which is the true Qiblah,”*21 This statement was also related to Mujahid, ‘Ata’ Ad-Dahhak, Ar-RabT bin Anas, As-Suddi, and others.’31 This last Ayah is similar to what Allah said: z 4\$3 # jduea iit sl 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way. If Allah had willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you; so compete in good deeds. The return of you (all) is to Allah.} (5:48) In the Ayah (2:148), Allah said: A.’j.f* ;isr jf& 5) 'A-i- Jilt iyjZS U '\$} 4Wheresoever you may be, Allah will bring you together (on the Day of Resurrection). Truly, Allah is able to do all things.} meaning: He is able to gather you from the earth even if your bodies and flesh disintegrated and scattered. L«j litJ j»«li j.\yd* jji cJLJ u £~»-j i J' ^ .'a.ojtlju J*1" i&z * tik ysi ^^ 4149. And from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah), that is indeed the truth from your Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what you do.} 4150. And from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn At-Jabari 3:193. ’2 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :121 ’ Ibn Abi Hatim 1:121-122.

your face in the direction of Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and wheresoever you are , turn your faces towards it (when you pray) so that men may have no argument against you except those of them that are wrongdoers, so fear them not, but fear Me! - And so that I may complete My blessings on you and that you may be guided.)

Why was changing the Qiblah mentioned thrice?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 436–447]

This is a third command from Allah to face Al-Masjid Al- Haram (the Sacred Mosque) from every part of the world (during prayer). It was said that Allah mentioned this ruling again here because it is connected to whatever is before and whatever is after it. Hence, Allah first said: y^ / •/ // # J ^ # t ^ v i Verily, We have seen the turning of your (Muhammad's) face to wards the heaven. Surely, We shall turn you to a Qiblah (prayer direction) that shall please you) (2:144), until: *(lie. Jiytf Uj p-fcd OylLd wACii iCertainly, the people who were given the Scripture (i.e., feius and the Christians) knozv well that, that (your turning towards the direction of the Ka'bah at Makkah in prayers) is the truth from their Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what they do.) (2:144) Allah mentioned in these Ayat His fulfillment of the Prophet’s wish and ordered him to face the Qiblah that he liked and is pleased with. In the second command, Allah said: tit eUj ^ A A*-* e.- jti) / ">«*•£ . •'S’ iAnd from wheresoever you start forth (for prayers), turn your face in the direction of Al-Masid Al-Haram that is indeed the truth from your Lord. And Allah is not unaware of what you do.) Therefore, Allah states here that changing the Qiblah is also

the truth from Him, thus upgrading the subject more than in the first Ayah, in which Allah agreed to what His Prophet

had wished for. Thus Allah states that this is also the truth from Him that He likes and is pleased with. In the third command, Allah refutes the Jewish assertion that the Prophet M faced their Qiblah, as they knew in their Books that the Prophet gg will later on be commanded to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim, the Ka'bah. The Arab disbelievers had no more argument concerning the Prophet's Qiblah after Allah commanded the Prophet gg to face the Qiblah of Ibrahim, which is more respected and honored, rather than the Qiblah of the Jews. The Arabs used to honor the Ka'bah and liked the fact that the Messenger gs was commanded to face it. The Wisdom behind abrogating the Previous Qiblah Allah said: \$...so that men may have no argument against you ^ Therefore, the People of the Book knew from the description of the Muslim Ummah that they would be ordered to face the Ka'bah. If the Muslims did not fit this description, the Jews would have used this fact against the Muslims. If the Muslims had remained on the Qiblah of Bayt Al-Maqdis, which was also the Qiblah of the Jews, this fact could have been used as the basis of argument by the Jews against other people. Allah's Statement: irk iAi 4 . . .except those of them that are wrongdoers, indicates the Mushrikin (polytheists) of Quraysh. The reasoning of these unjust persons was the unsound statement: "This man (Muhammad) claims that he follows the religion of Ibrahim! Hence, if his facing Bayt Al-Maqdis was a part of the religion of Ibrahim, why did he change it?" The answer to this question is that Allah has chosen His Prophet gg to face Bayt Al-Maqdis first for certain wisdom, and he obeyed Allah

regarding this command. Then, Allah changed the Qiblah to the Qiblah of Ibrahim, which is the Ka'bah, and he also obeyed Allah in this command. He, obeys Allah in all cases and never engages in the defiance of Allah even for an instant, and his Ummah imitates him in this.

Allah said: 4...so fear them not, but fear Me!} meaning: 'Do not fear the doubts that the unjust, stubborn persons raise and fear Me Alone.' Indeed, Allah Alone deserves to be feared. Allah said: 4&&& } 4...so that I may complete My blessings on you.} This Ayah relates to Allah's statement: j£& jjUjj, •h,} .so that men may have no argument against you}, meaning: I will perfect My bounty on you by legislating for you to face the Ka'bah, so that the (Islamic) Shari'ah (law) is complete in every respect. Allah said: 4c2fc2 -fJ&j} .that you may be guided.}, meaning: To be directed and guided to what the nations have been led astray from. We have guided you to it and preferred you with it.' This is why this Ummah is the best and most honored nation ever. 4 1^5 S&5S %P <5 £ **46 4151. Similarly (to complete My blessings on you). We have sent among you a Messenger (Muhammad ig) of your own, reciting to you Our verses (the Qur'an) and purifying you, and teaching you the Book (the Qur'an) and the Hikmah (i.e., Sunnah, Islamic laws and Fiqh - jurisprudence), and teaching you that which you did not know.} 4152. Therefore remember Me (by praying, glorifying). I will remember you, and be grateful to Me (for My countless favors on you) and never be ungrateful to Me.}

Muhammad's Prophecy is a Great Bounty from Allah Allah reminds His believing servants with what He has endowed them with by sending Muhammad as a Messenger to them, reciting to them Allah's clear Ayat and purifying and cleansing them from the worst types of behavior, the ills of the souls and the acts of JdhUiyyah (pre-Islamic era). The Messenger 3§ also takes them away from the darkness (of disbelief) to the light (of faith) and teaches them the Book, the Qur'an, and the Hikmah (i.e., the

wisdom), which is his Sunnah. He also teaches them what they knew not. During the time of JdhUiyyah, they used to utter foolish statements. Later on, and with the blessing of the Prophet's Message and the goodness of his prophecy, they were elevated to the status of the Awliya' (loyal friends of Allah) and the rank of the scholars. Hence, they acquired the deepest knowledge among the people, the most pious hearts, and the most truthful tongues. Allah said: 'aM i j >' * f. ->i Scuiifi .U ill ilIndeed, Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger (Muhammad from among themselves, reciting unto them His verses (the Qur'an), and purifying them (from sins).} (3:164) Allah also criticized those who did not give this bounty its due consideration, when He said: 4 r J,* \$ illi ijlje j) J fi\} iHave you not seen those who have changed the favors of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet Muhammad and his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} (14:28) Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Allah's favor means Muhammad."*11 Therefore, Allah has commanded the believers to affirm this favor and to appreciate it by thanking and remembering Him: ^Therefore, remember Me. I will remember you, and be grateful to Me, and never be ungrateful to Me.} Al-Bukhari no . 3977.

Mujahid said that Allah's statement: 4Similarly (to complete My favor on you), We have sent among you a Messenger (Muhammad 0) of your own,\$ means: Therefore, remember Me in gratitude to My favor. Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented about Allah's statement: ipn 4Therefore remember Me. I will remember you "Remember Me regarding what I have commanded you and I will remember you regarding what I have compelled Myself to do for your benefit (i.e., His rewards and forgiveness).""2' An authentic Hadlth states: VI' '-i- r* J - ^ri CAJ uAllah the Exalted said, 'Whoever mentions Me to himself, then I will mention him to Myself; and whoever mentions Me in a gathering, I will mention him in a better gathering ,»'13 ' Imam Ahmad reported that Anas narrated that Allah's Messenger said: 0) Jt J Je'J 3* «»' jlj - J~>- J -Jli A ~ iSsiyim Irt J J A?] jlj tlpU aJuu o^o Iplji Je jlj ilpljj the Exalted said, 'O son of Adam! If you mention Me to yourself, I will mention you to Myself. If you mention Me in a gathering, I will mention you in a gathering of the angels (or said in a better gathering). If you draw closer to Me by a hand span, I will draw closer to you by forearm's length. If you draw closer to Me by a forearm's length, I will draw closer to you by an arm's length . And if you come to Me walking, I will come 111 At-Tabari 3:210. (2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :141 131 FathAl-Bari 13:395.

441 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) J mm T t 'jv»jE'o? j^h>44j^ jJ>j j oy»-j Hj'jauUHjSfiiluiip^t'CA (j f j'j \$.^SjiaJJ4jjf jloill >gS-lf+i -? <C~'\ . *-f C i- ..-'."if" iT-r -«i to you runnings. Its chain is Sahih, it was recorded by Al- Bukhari. 111 Allah said: % J 4...and be grateful to Me (for My countless favors on you) and never be ungrateful to Me.} In this Ayah, Allah commands that He be thanked and appreciated, and promises even more rewards for thanking Him. Allah said in another Ayah: od f\$3j 'fi&iff j^jE=zC. 4V\,%& u'i jj 4And (remember) token your Lord proclaimed : "If you give thanks (by accepting faith and worshipping none but Allah), I will give you more (of My blessings); but if you are thankless (i.e., disbelievers), verily, My punishment is indeed severe. Abu Raja' Al-'Utaridi said: 'Imran bin Husayn came by us once wearing a nice silken garment that we never saw him wear before or afterwards. He said, "Allah's Messenger jg said: £JJ '-kij (_)!*• J>\ i&fi «5>l jji ilAj lit ^Ju\ t.xJ. Jit :¥Ja "Those whom Allah has favored with a bounty, then Allah likes 111 Ahmad 3 :138 , Path Al-Bdri 13 :52 1

442 Tafsir Ibn Kathir to see the effect of His bounty on His creation », or he said, “on His servant” - according to Ruh (one of the narrators of the Hadith) ff\ jSj! JJ ijJjii 'ij yrjitjcSli ^ IA^— !A** ^ Lj ^ : 53j» L .Jit _LJk—' ij 4153. O you who believe! Seek help in patience and As-Saldh (the prayer). Truly, Allah is with As-Sabirin (the patient).} 4154. And say not of those who are killed in the way of Allah, "They are dead." Nay, they are living, but you perceive (it) not.} The Virtue of Patience and Prayer After Allah commanded that He be appreciated, He ordained patience and prayer. It is a fact that the servant is either enjoying a bounty that he should be thankful for, or suffering a calamity that he should meet with patience. A Hadith states: 015 yojj oiio oi : *J 'js- N) *tAt» ^ t-j 'fj- ois oLii olj d oAmazing is the believer, for whatever Allah decrees for him, it is better for him! If he is tested with a bounty, he is grateful for it and this is better for him; and if he is afflicted with a hardship, he is patient with it and this is better for him. Allah has stated that the best tools to help ease the effects of the afflictions are patience and prayer. Earlier we mentioned Allah's statement: i? -*1^ 4And seek help in patience and As-Saldh (the prayer) and tndy, it is extremely heavy and hard except for Al-Khdshi'in [i.e., the true believers in Allah]} (2:45) There are several types of Sabr— patience: one for avoiding the prohibitions and sins, one for acts of worship and obedience. The second type carries more rewards than the first I 1 * Ahmad 4 :438. > Muslim 4:2292.

443 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) type. There is a third type of patience required in the face of the afflictions and hardships, which is mandatory, like repentance. 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “Sabr has two parts: patience for the sake of Allah concerning what He is pleased with (i.e., acts of worship and obedience), even if it is hard on the heart and the body, and patience when avoiding what He dislikes, even if it is desired. Those who acquire these qualities will be among the patient persons whom Allah shall greet (when they meet Him in the Hereafter; refer to Surat Al- Ahzab 33:44), Allah willing.”¹¹¹ The Life enjoyed by Martyrs Allah's statement: 4“^ j* kyl y' Ssf* 4 CA iAnd say not of those who are killed in the way of Allah, "They are dead.” Nay, they are living indicates that the martyrs are alive and receiving their sustenance. Muslim reported in his Sahih * •C>Jl tj~a>- Jb il ^1jj\ jl® liU :JUi Aijj e JjJl Si |JL». { iaxJ U LlixP I jSj J lijj Ij : I flii ?jyw Ijlj Ul# tJia ... ^ Ij I/: ojs tij - ”s Ais jii jiL~i j ;\21 uijji jijji ^J\ . a : 'JjL*- fs? Jyl* — ;S1^1)1 tjli «T7ie sow/s 0/ f/ie martyrs are inside green birds and move about in Paradise wherever they wish. Tlten, they take refuge in lamps that are hanging under the Throne (of Allah). Your Lord looked at them and asked them, "What do you wish for?" They said, 'What more could we wish for while You have favored us with what You have not favored any other of your creation?' He repeated the question again. When they realize lhal they will be asked (until they answer), they said, “We wish that You send (M Ibn Abi Hatim 1:144.

surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard (for the cause of Allah) and As-Sabirfn (the patient), and We shall test your facts (i.e., the one who is a liar, and the one who is truthful).} (47:31) Hence, He tests them with the bounty sometimes and sometimes with the afflictions of fear and hunger. Allah said in another Ayah J-Q 111 4So Allah made it taste extreme of hunger (famine) and fear.} (16:112) The frightened and the hungry persons show the effects of the affliction outwardly and this is why Allah has used here the word 'Libas' (cover or clothes) of fear and hunger. In the Ayat above, Allah used the words: iwith something of fear, hunger,} meaning, a little of each. Then (Allah said), Sj oftj} iloss of wealth, } meaning, some of the wealth will be destroyed, ij*%} Olives} meaning, losing friends, relatives and loved ones to death, iattd fruits,} meaning, the gardens and the farms will not produce the

usual or expected amounts. This is why Allah said next: ^{4j} but give glad tidings to As-Sdbirfn (the patient). } He then explained whom He meant by ‘the patient’ whom He praised:

446 Tafstr Ibt Kathir 5 4 j&} 4W7io, when afflicted with calamity, say: "Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return . " } meaning, those who recite this statement to comfort themselves in the face of their loss, know that they belong to Allah and that He does what He wills with His servants. They also know that nothing and no deed, even if it was the weight of an atom, will be lost with Allah on the Day of Resurrection. These facts thus compel them to admit that they are Allah’s servants and that their return will be to Him in the Hereafter. This is why Allah said: ... y . A* ", A_r-i\ Lit iThey are those on whom are the Salawat (i.e., who are blessed and will be forgiven) from their Lord, and (they are those who) receive His mercy,> meaning, Allah’s praise and mercy will be with them. Said bin Jubayr added, “Meaning, safety from the torment.” iand it is they who are the guided ones . TJmar bin Al- Khattab commented: “What righteous things, and what a great heights. iThey are those on whom are the Salawat from their Lord, and (they are those who) receive His mercy} are the two righteous things. iattd it is they who are the guided ones} are the heights. The heights means more rewards, and these people will be awarded their rewards and more. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:158. 121 Al-Hakim 2:270.

447Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2)

The Virtue of asserting that We all belong to Allah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 447–448]

during Afflictions There are several Ahadith that mention the rewards of admitting that the return is to Allah by saying: #21 fyj k fy) i"Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return.'y when afflictions strike. For instance, Imam Ahmad reported that Umm Salamah narrated: Once, Abu Salamah came back after he was with Allah’s Messenger jg and said: I heard Allah’s Messenger jg recite a statement that made me delighted. He said: \j^-\ “Aj illJS Jii Slj 1 1\$-; ijl es? 4No Muslim is struck with an affliction and then says Istirja when the affliction strikes, and then says : 'O Allah! Rezoard me for my loss and give me what is better than it/ but Allah will do just that. Umm Salamah said: So I memorized these words. When Abu Salamah died I said Istitja.' and said: “O Allah! Compensate me for my loss and give me what is better than it.” I then thought about it and said, “Who is better than Abu Salamah?” When my ‘Iddah (the period of time before the widow or divorced woman can remarry) finished, Allah’s Messenger sg asked for permission to see me while I was dyeing a skin that I had. I washed my hands, gave him permission to enter and handed him a pillow, and he sat on it. He then asked me for marriage and when he finished his speech, I said, “O Messenger of Allah! It is not because I do not want you, but I am very jealous and I fear that you might experience some wrong mannerism from me for which Allah would punish me. I am old and have children.” He said: yLJ\ U Ulj J y, Ail 14-A-jj 1— Sjj! Iy y’ffs U tab JUU* JU*JI jyi !j niLLil ^.ill -lii

448 Tafsir Ibn Kathir «As for the jealousy that you mentioned, Allah the Exalted will remove it from you As for your being old as you mentioned, I lurve suffered what you have suffered. And for your having children, they are my children too.» She said, “I have surrendered to Allah’s Messenger.” Allah’s Messenger sg married her and Umm Salamah said later, “Allah compensated me with who is better

than Abu Salamah: Allah's Messenger Muslim reported a shorter version of this Hadith. Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on him who performs Hajj or 'Umrah (pilgrimage) of the House to perform Tawaf between them. And whoever does good voluntarily, then verily, Allah is All- Recognizer, All-Knower

The Meaning of “it is not a sin” in the Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 448–485]

Imam Ahmad reported that 'Urwah said that he asked 'A'ishah about what Allah stated: Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah (two mountains in Makkah) are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on him who performs Hajj or 'Umrah (pilgrimage) of the House (the Ka'bah at Makkah) to perform the going (Tawaf) between them (As-Safa and Al-Marwah). “By Allah! It is not a sin if someone did not perform Tawaf around them.” 'A'ishah said, “Worst is that which you said, O my nephew! If this is the meaning of it, it should have read, It is not a sin if one did not perform Tawaf around them.” Ahmad 4:27. Muslim 2:633. The names of the two small mountains that the pilgrims walk and run between during the rites of 'Umrah.

Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2 is not a sin if one did not perform Tawaf around them.' Rather, the Ayah was revealed regarding the Ansar, who before Islam, used to assume Ihlal (or Ihram for Hajj) in the area of Mushallal for their idol Manat that they used to worship, Those who assumed Ihlal for Manat, used to hesitate to perform Tawaf (going) between Mounts As-Safa and Al-Marwah. So they (during the Islamic era) asked Allah's Messenger about it, saying, 'O Messenger of Allah! During the time of Jahiliyyah, we used to hesitate to perform Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah.' Allah then revealed: Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah. So it is not a sin on him who performs Hajj or 'Umrah of the House to perform the going (Tawaf) between them.’ 'A'ishah then said, “ Allah's Messenger has made it the Sunnah to perform Tawaf between them (As-Safa and Al-Marwah), and thus, no one should abandon performing Tawaf between them.” This Hadith is reported in the Sahihayn. In another narration, Imam Az-Zuhri reported that 'Urwah said: Later on 'Urwah told Abu Bakr bin 'Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Harith bin Hisham (of 'A'ishah's statement) and he said, “I have not heard of such information. However, I heard learned men saying that all the people, except those whom 'A'ishah mentioned, said, 'Our Tawaf between these two hills is a practice of Jahiliyyah.' Some others among the Ansar said, “We were commanded to perform Tawaf of the Ka'bah, but not between As-Safa and Al-Marwah.' So Allah revealed: Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah. Abu Bakr bin 'Abdur-Rahman then said, “It seems that this verse was revealed concerning the two groups.” Al-Bukhari collected a similar narration by Anas. Ash-Shahi said, “Isaf (an idol) was on As-Safa while Na'ilah *** Ahmad 6:144. Path Al-Bari 3 :581 , and Muslim 2 :929

(an idol) was on Al-Marwah, and they used to touch (or kiss) them. After Islam came, they were hesitant about performing Tawaf between them. Thereafter, the Ayah (2:158 above) was revealed.” The Wisdom behind legislating Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah Muslim recorded a long Hadith in his Sahih from Jabir, in which Allah's Messenger finished the Tawaf around the House, and then went back to the Rukn (pillar, i.e., the Black Stone) and kissed it. He then went out from the door near As-Safa while reciting: Verily, As-Safa and Al-Marwah are of the symbols of Allah.) The Prophet then said, «I start with what Allah has commanded me to start with [meaning start the Tawaf with the Sa'i (i.e., fast

walking) from the As-Safdp. In another narration of An-Nasa'i, the Prophet sg said, «Start with what Allah has started with (i.e., As-SafaJ.® Imam Ahmad reported that Hablbah bint Abu Tajrah said, "I saw Allah's Messenger jg performing Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah, while the people were in front of him and he was behind them walking in Sa'L I saw his garment twisted around his knees because of the fast walking in Sa'i (he was performing) and he was reciting: 'JcU CSS il oPerform Sa'i, for Allah has prescribed Sa'i on i/oi/ This Hadith was used as a proof for the fact that Sa'i is a Rukn)3] of Hajj. It was also said that Sa'i is Wajib} and not a Rukn of Hajj and that if one does not perform it by mistake or by intention, he could expiate the shortcoming with Muslim and An-Nasa'i 5 :239 121 Ahmad 6:421. A pillar, which if not performed, then the act of worship must be repeated An obligatory element, which if not performed can be expiated as directed

451Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 374) (Part-2) Damm. 1' 1 Allah has stated that Tawaf between As-Safa and Al-Marwah is among the symbols of Allah, meaning, among the acts that Allah legislated during the Hajj for Prophet Ibrahim. Earlier we mentioned the Hadlth by Ibn 'Abbas that the origin of Tawaf comes from the Tawaf of Hajar (Prophet Ibrahim's wife), between As-Safa and Al-Marwah seeking water for her son (Isma'il) Ibrahim had left them in Makkah, where there was no habitation for her. When Hajar feared that her son would die, she stood up and begged Allah for His help and kept going back and forth in that blessed area between As- Safa and Al-Marwah. She was humble, fearful, frightened and meek before Allah. Allah answered her prayers, relieved her of her loneliness, ended her dilemma and made the well of Zamzam bring forth its water for her, which is: OaJij . -"As «A tasty (or nutritional)food and a remedyfor the illness .» Therefore, whoever performs Sa't between As-Safa and Al- Marwah should remember his meekness, humbleness and need for Allah to guide his heart, lead his affairs to success and forgive his sins. He should also want Allah to eliminate his shortcomings and errors and to guide him to the straight path. He should ask Allah to keep him firm on this path until he meets death, and to change his situation from that of sin and errors to that of perfection and being forgiven, — the same providence which was provided to Hajar. Allah then states: fcp&& 4And whoever does good voluntarily. \$ It was said that the Ayah describes performing Tawaf more than seven times, it was also said that it refers to voluntary 'Umrah or Hajj. It was also said that it means volunteering to do good works in general, as Ar-Razi has stated. The third opinion was attributed to Al-Hasan Al-Basri.^ Allah knows best. A form of expiation in which an animal is slaughtered in Makkah and distributed among the poor Ar-Razi 4 :146.

Allah states: ^iJc \$12 if6^ 4...then verily, Allah is All-Recognizer, All-Knower.) meaning, Allah's reward is immense for the little deed, and He knows about the sufficiency of the reward. Hence, He will not award insufficient rewards to anyone. Indeed: ftS 25! os 'f "\-l I." iSurely, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of an atom, but if there is any good (done), He doubles it, and givesfrom Him a great reward.) (4:40)]tj£. 4\$ dLdjts l/X4> i>; \$j(^ 'it <*(^ \)Cj \££ z\$ % v\$» btj 4'faj'^{\$£ f "5lj j+r£' oirt V ujLitf} 4159. Verily, those who conceal the clear proofs, evidences and the guidance, which We have sent down, after We have made it clear for the People in the Book, they are the ones cursed by Allah and cursed by the cursers.) 4160. Except those who repent and do righteous deeds, and openly declare (the truth which they concealed). These, I will accept their repentance. And I am the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.) 4161. Verily, those who disbelieve, and die while they are disbelievers, it is they on whom is the curse ofAllah and of the angels and ofmankind, combined.) 4162. They will

abide therein (under the curse in Hell), their punishment will neither be lightened nor will they be reprieved). The Eternal Curse for Those Who hide Religious Commandments These Ayat sternly warn against those who hide the clear signs that the Messengers were sent with which guide to the correct path and beneficial guidance for the hearts, after Allah

453 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) has made such aspects clear for His servants through the Books that He revealed to His Messengers. Abu Al-'Aliyah said that these Ayat, “were revealed about the People of the Scripture who hid the description of Muhammad jg. ”* 1 Allah then states that everything curses such people for this evil act. Certainly, just as everything asks for forgiveness for the scholar, even the fish in the sea and the bird in the air, then those who hide knowledge are cursed by Allah and by the cursers. A Hadith in the Musnad, narrated through several chains of narrators, that strengthens the overall judgment of the Hadith, states that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah’s Messenger jg said: IrJ pi* If Jr- "Whoever was asked about knowledge that one has, but lie hid it, then a bridle made of fire will be tied around his mouth on

the Day of Resurrection It is also recorded by Al-Bukhari that Abu Hurayrah said, “If it was not for an Ayah in Allah’s Book, I would not have narrated a Hadith for anyone: iVerily, those who conceal the clear proofs, evidences and the guidance, which We have sent down,}’ [3] Mujahid said, “When the earth is struck by drought, the animals say, This is because of the sinners among the Children of Adam. May Allah curse the sinners among the Children of Adam.”*4 Abu Al-’Aliyah, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas and Qatadah said that iand cursed by the cursers} means that the angels and the believers will curse them.’5’ **’ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :170. 121 Ahmad 2:495. 131 Fath Al-Bari 1 :258. •4| Ibn Abi Hatim 1:175. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:174.

Moreover, a Hadith states that everything, including the fish in the sea, asks for forgiveness for the scholars. The Ayah (2:159 above) states that those who hide the knowledge will be cursed, (in this life and) on the Day of Resurrection, by Allah, the angels, all humanity, and those who curse (including the animals) each in its own distinct way. Allah knows best. From this punishment, Allah excluded all who repent to Him: ijtf ^Except those who repent and do righteous deeds, and openly declare (the truth which they concealed). This Ayah refers to those who regret what they have been doing and correct their behavior and, thus, explain to the people what they have been hiding. 4.Art)' 4\$' tits ¥ iThese, I will accept their repentance. And I am the One Wlw accepts repentance, the Most Merciful. \$ This Ayah also indicates that those who used to call to innovation, or even disbelief, and repent to Allah, then Allah will forgive them. Allah afterwards states that those who disbelieve in Him and remain in this state until they die, then: iit is they on whom is the curse of Allah and of the angels and of mankind, combined. They will abide therein (under the curse in Hell). Therefore, they will suffer the eternal curse until the Day of Resurrection and after that in the fire of Jahannam, where, itheir punishment ivill neither be lightened Hence, the torment will not be decreased for them, i>ior will they be reprieved. ^ The torment will not be changed or tempered for even an hour. Rather, it is continuous and eternal. We seek refuge

with Allah from this evil end. Cursing the Disbelievers is allowed There is no disagreement that it is lawful to curse the disbelievers. ‘Umar bin Al-Khattab and the Imams after him used to curse the disbelievers in their Qunut (a type of supplication) during the prayer and otherwise. As for cursing a

specific disbeliever, some scholars stated that it is not allowed to curse him, because we do not know how Allah will make his end. Others said that it is allowed to curse individual disbelievers. For proof, they mention the story about the man who was brought to be punished repeatedly for drinking (alcohol), a man said, “May Allah curse him! He is being brought repeatedly (to be flogged for drinking).” Allah’s Messenger jg said: “Do not curse him, for he loves Allah and His Messengers. 111 This Hadith indicates that it is allowed to curse those who do not love Allah and His Messenger sg. Allah knows best. 244 V is4 4163. And your Hah (Cod) is One Halt (God - Allah), La ildha ilia Huiua (there is none who has the right to be worshipped but He), the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} In this Ayah, Allah mentions that He is the only deity, and that He has no partners or equals. He is Allah, the One and Only, the Sustainer, and there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He is the Most Gracious— Ar-Rahman, the Most Merciful— Ar-Rahlm. We explained the meanings of these two Names in the beginning of Surat Al-Fatihah. Shahr bin Hawshab reported that Asma’ bint Yazid bin As-Sakan narrated that Allah’s Messenger jg said: jzy*&&j 4*^'^^ |s «Allah's Greatest Name is contained in these tzvo Ayah: f'nV; && \$44V is4 Abdur-Razzdq 7 :381 , similar with Al-Bukhari, no. 6780.

456 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4Ami your Ildh (God) is One Ildh (God - Al- lah), La ilalta ilia Huwa (there is none who has the right to be wor- shipped but He), the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} and: jji ji v sif ; 4Alif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! La ilaha ilia Huwa (none has the right to be wor- shipped but He), Al-Haiyul-Qaiyum (the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and pro- tects all that exists).} (3:1, 2)”m Then Allah mentions some of the proof that He is alone as the deity, that He is the One who created the heavens and the earth and all of the various creatures between them, all of which testify to His Oneness. Allah said: J ami 1^3 jJij *X» {j 'J ilA; oj& ills jib i^ j 1 1 0 4> iil dll'jiSAlj \$ chi W -/4* 4 4-^' 4 oi t,j vLj .Tf j* is! 3\$ ^4 4264. Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, and the ships which sail through the sea with that which is of use to mankind, and the water (rain) which Allah sends down from the sky and makes Abu DAwud 2 :168.

457Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) the earth alive therewith after its death, and the moving (living) creatures of all kinds that He has scattered therein, and in the veering of winds and clouds which are held between the sky and the earth, are indeed Aydt (proofs, evidences, signs, etc.) for people of understanding.} The Proofs for Tawhid Allah said: ^Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth... } Therefore, the sky, with its height, intricate design, vastness, the heavenly objects in orbit, and this earth, with its density, its lowlands, mountains, seas, deserts, valleys, and other structures, and beneficial things that it has. Allah continues: . . .and in the alternation of night and day.} This (the night) comes and then goes followed by the other (the day) which does not delay for even an instant, just as Allah said: ^ \$%A&& J iip v} \$It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:40) Sometimes, the day grows shorter and the night longer, and sometimes vice versa, one takes from the length of the other. Similarly Allah said: ip 4 'JAA £4*5 aSp e4y> iAllah merges the night into the day, and He merges the day into the night} (57 :6) meaning, He extends the length of one from the other and vice versa. Allah then continues: . . .and the ships which sail through the sea with that which is of use to mankind,} Shaping the sea in this manner, so that it is able to carry

458 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ships from one shore to another, so people benefit from what the other region has, and export what they have to them and vice versa. Allah then continues: 4'iLr* -*~*) ji oi ill ^ 4 and the water (rain) which Allah sends down from the sky and makes the earth alive therewith after its death}, which is similar to Allah's statement: 4.TT,U>^=t -cJ> ui iLil 'p> 4And a sign for them is the dead land. We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} (36:33), until: iwhich they know not.} (36:36) Allah continues: iand the moving (living) creatures of all kinds that He has scattered therein,} meaning, in various shapes, colors, uses and sizes, whether small or large. Allah knows all that, sustains it, and nothing is concealed from Him. Similarly, Allah said: 4 j&j if>jy S yi ^:V(^ iSL^ tj} iAnd no moving (living) creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit (in the uterus or grave) . All is in a Clear Book (Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz — the Book of Decrees with Allah).} (11 :6) 'jiSZ>} 4 . . .and in the veering ofwinds ... } Sometimes, the wind brings mercy and sometimes torment. Sometimes it brings the good news of the clouds that follow it, sometimes it leads the clouds, herding them, scattering them or directing them. Sometimes, the wind comes from the north

459Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) (the northern wind), and sometimes from the south, sometimes from the east, and striking the front of the Ka'bah, sometimes from the west, striking its back. There are many books about the wind rain, stars and the regulations related to them, but here is not the place to elaborate on that, and Allah knows best. Allah continues: &S&% 4 ...and clouds which are held between the sky and the earth, } The clouds run between the sky and the earth to wherever Allah wills of lands and areas. Allah said next: 4 . . .are indeed Aydt for people of understanding, } meaning, all these things are clear signs that testify to Allah's Oneness. Similarly, Allah said: ' J'H fofol\$ -ikfoj 4 .-.Vu. C Clj 4»jV'j 4 ffo) bjoj Uilt ii)' 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding. Those who remember Allah (always, and in prayers) standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides, and think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the earth, (saying): "Our Lord! You have not created (all) this without purpose, glory to You! (Exalted are You above all that they associate with You as partners). Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire."} (3:190, 191) ili. J4.1 XfoW c^i'j «ai "T^ ^'-*i\$ ujii ai tr ixi ill olj &,* »yj' ul i) sii 4S j!j ^2. 'Sij ^ u \i4 n t&d & a*? i cr^ £3 (3 i sit

460 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4165. And of mankind are some who take (for worship) others besides Allah as rivals (to Allah). They love them as they love Allah. But those who believe, love Allah more (than anything else). Ifonly, those who do wrong could see, when they will see the torment, that all power belongs to Allah and that Allah is severe in punishment.} 4166. When those who were followed disown (declare themselves innocent of) those whofollowed (than), and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut offfrom them}. 4167. And those who followed will say : "If only we had one more chance to return (to the worldly life), we would disown (declare ourselves as innocentfrom) than as they have disowned (declared thanselves as innocent from) us." Thus Allah will show them their deeds as regrets for them . And they will never get out of the Fire.} The Condition of the Polytheists in this Life and the Hereafter In these Ayat, Allah mentions the condition of the polytheists in this life and their destination in the Hereafter. They appointed equals and rivals with Allah, worshipping them along with Allah and loving them, just as they love Allah. However, Allah is the only deity worthy of worship, Who has neither rival nor opponent nor partner. It is reported in the Sahlhayn that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud

said: I said, "O Messenger of Allah! What is the greatest sin?" He said: «To appoint a rival to Allah while He Alone has created Allah said: 4 jS. ifjfoj} 4But those who believe, love Allah more (than anything else)} Because these believers love Allah, know His greatness, revere Him, believe in His Oneness, then they do not associate Fath Al-Bari 8 :3 and Muslim 1 :90,

461Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2 anything or anyone with Him in the worship. Rather, they worship Him Alone, depend on Him and they seek help from Him for each and every need. Then, Allah warns those who commit Shirk, if only, those who do wrong could see, when they will see the torment, that all power belongs to Allah.) if these people knew what they will face and the terrible punishment they are to suffer because of their disbelief and Shirk (polytheism), then they would shun the deviation that they live by. Allah mentions their false beliefs in their idols, and that those they followed will declare their innocence of them. Allah said: u 'J4 U& X2 }When those who were fallowed disown (declare themselves innocent of) those who fallowed (them).} the angels, whom they used to claim that they worshipped, declare their innocence of them in the Hereafter, saying: }We declare our innocence (from them) before You. It was not us they worshipped.} (28:63), and: JL'.> it \ X, ' . i'-iT [' ** . * C.i' 4"Glorified be You! You are our Walt (Lord) instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most of than were believers in than."} (34:4) The Jinn will also disown the disbelievers who worshipped them, and they will reject that worship. Allah said: k *. ^ y k yk ce !> J-t S-k yfa iAtid who is more astray than one who calls on (invokes) besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls (invocations) to them? And when mankind are gathered (on the

Day of Resurrection), they (false deities) will become their enemies and xoill deny their worshipping> (46:5, 6) Allah said: , /y /> Kf, n*~ iAnd they have taken (for worship) alihah (gods) besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory (and also protect them from Allah' punishment). Nay, but they (the so- called gods) zoill deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them (on the Day of Resurrection) (19:81, 82) Prophet Ibrahim said to his people: i • (4 ~>\y» bijji' JJ*' o/i iri p5==*i Jill' till) p-'SaJi.i > • ' 4You have taken (for ivorship) idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you shall have no helper. (29:25) Allah said: 4y4 4\$' d) f-ry iy i[Isj Jljf Ciftt il/£~A g;jK jfc Jij^J iy...,T *.t ' 'Ju / ,£p35i, ^ ,« V V- / * 'it' x V/ . , y 1/{ _> . > crtijt J5j ^pcA4/^ Jf)<U i[^ \yu^a^>\ > > • > - csj> l&t 4But if you could see when the Zdlimiin (polytheists and wrongdoers) xoill be made to stand before their Lord, how they xoill cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant : "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!" And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed xoeak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were Mujrimin (polytheists, sinners, disbelievers, criminals)." Those who were deetned xoeak will say

463Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) to those who were arrogant : "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets (for disobeying Allah during this worldly life), when they behold the tonnent. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} (34:31-33) Allah said: U 4 & 4 4&\$ os 4 41 tj 4And

Shaytdn (Satan) will say when the matter has been decided: "Verily , Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. So blame me not, but blame yourselves. I cannot help you, nor can you help me. I deny your former act in associating me (Satan) as a partner with Allah (by obeying me in the life of the world). Verily, there is a painful torment for the Zdlmxdn (polytheists and wrongdoers).} (14:22) Allah then said: i...and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut off from than.} meaning, when they see Allah's torment, their power and means of salvation are all cut off, and they will have no way of making amends, nor will they find a way of escape from the Fire. 'Ata' reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about: 444-' jj-fj)} i then all their relations will be cut off from than.} "meaning the friendship." Mujahid reported a similar statement in another narration by Ibn Abu Najlh. m At-Jabari 3 :290

464 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah said: cr fa£3 G £\ i \p\$\\ sif those who followed will say: "If only we had one more chance to return (to the worldly life), we would disown (declare ourselves as innocent from) them as they have disowned (declared themselves as innocent from) us.'f This Ayah means: 'If we only had a chance to go back to the life so that we could disown them (their idols, leaders, etc.) shun their worship, ignore them and worship Allah Alone instead.' But they utter a lie in this regard, because if they were given the chance to go back, they would only return to what they were prohibited from doing, just as Allah said. This is why Allah said: iii iThus Allah will show them their deeds as regrets for them.)» meaning, their works will vanish and disappear. Similarly, Allah said: 4And We shall turn to whatever deeds they (disbelievers, polytheists, sinners) did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust> (25:23) Allah also said: iThe parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously on a stormy day (14:18), and: 4&&& £1* iLi J? yjfr 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water .> (24:39) This is why Allah said— at the end of the Ayah 2:167 above iAnd they zoitl never get out of the Fire.>

ji£p ft tjliS -Si qp ^, Vt 4 li* 1# 4 .j'-Ujit" 7 l> <uli ,jt Ijlyj Jj fePt ift . UV.CJ^ 4168. O mankind! Eat of that which is lawful and good on the earth, and follow not the footsteps of Shaytan (Satan). Verily, he is to you an open enemy.4 4169. He (Satan) commands you only what is evil and Faltsha' (sinful), and that you should say about Allah what you know not.\$ The Order to eat the Lawful Things, and the Prohibition of following the Footsteps of Shaytan After Allah stated that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and that He Alone created the creation, He stated that He is the Sustainer for all His creation, and He mentioned a favor that He granted them; He has allowed them to eat any of the pure lawful things on the earth that do not cause harm to the body or the mind. He also forbade them from following the footsteps of Shaytan, meaning his ways and methods with which he misguides his followers, like prohibiting the Bahirah (a she-camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it), or Sa'ibah (a she-camel let loose for free pasture for the idols and nothing was allowed to be carried on it), or a Wasilah (a she-camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a she-camel at its first delivery and then again gives birth to a she-camel at its second delivery), and all of the other things that Shaytan made attractive to them during the time of Jahiliyyah. Muslim recorded 'Iyad bin Himar saying that Allah's Messenger gjg said that Allah the Exalted says, oJL»- ^j - j+i ^jIip JU JS a'Every type of wealth I have endowed My servants is allowed for them...' (until), 7 have created

My servants Hunafd' (pure or upright), but the devils came to them and led them astray from their (true) religion and prohibited them from what I

467 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) adultery and so forth. He commands you to commit what is even worse, that is, saying about Allah without knowledge.' So this includes every innovator and disbeliever. t Si, t jj >j)U "i titi; si> ;Taji &S Sfi v Vi S 4170. Whoi it is said to them : ",Folloio what Allah has sent down." They say: "Nay! We shall follow what we found our fathers following." (Would they do that!) even though their fathers did not understand anything nor were they guided?} 4172. And the example of those who disbelieve is as that of him who shouts to those (flock of sheep) that hear nothing but calls and cries. (They are) deaf, dumb and blind. So they do not understand The Polytheist imitates Other Polytheists Allah states that if the disbelievers and polytheists are called to follow what Allah has revealed to His Messenger and abandon the practices of misguidance and ignorance that they indulge in, they will say, "Rather. We shall follow what we found our fathers following," meaning, worshipping the idols and the false deities. Allah criticized their reasoning: 'Yu' * s.' t Si ijl ISill U \jj ojjLEj S+S iTijilc.j tc ^/4^o6i JJ#EJSj j Vi oySSsYjYSXj.f* 'Si Ijf^ V 'aji u\jSty's (w) _LJJ jS*aS 1Jl ifjil 1 ^

aw# -m 4(Would they do that!) even though their fathers}, meaning, those whom they follow and whose practices they imitate, and: i'ojX-Z% •)} i . . . did not understand anything nor were they guided?} meaning, they had no sound understanding or guidance. Ibn Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that this was revealed about a group of Jews whom Allah's Messenger jg called to Islam, but they refused, saying, "Rather, we shall follow what we found our forefathers following." So Allah revealed this Ayah (2:170) above."111 The Disbeliever is just like an Animal Allah then made a parable of the disbelievers, just as He said in another Ayah: 4For those who believe not in the Hereafter is an evil description.} (16:60) Similarly, Allah said here (2:171 above) '&} }And the example of those who disbelieve. . . } meaning, in their injustice, misguidance and ignorance, they are just like wandering animals, not understanding what they are told; if the shepherd heralds them or calls them to what benefits them, they would not understand what is actually being said to them, for they only hear unintelligible sounds. This is what is reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata', Al-Hasan, Qatadah, 'Ata' Al- Khurasani and Ar-RabT bin Anas. 121 £5p} 111 At-Tabari 3:305. 121 Ibn Abi HStim 1 : 225-228.

469 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2) iThey are deaf, dumb, and blind.} means, they are deaf, as they do not hear the truth; mute, as they do not utter it; and blind, as they do not see or recognize its path and way. 4So they do not understand.} means, they do not comprehend or understand anything. 4 a Ufcis c +Q Oi \pa <u\$,>j 4)>l jyii 'ti f 5J ^ "£> gi? jjfc 4172. O you who believe (in the Oneness of Allah - Islamic Monotheism)! Eat of the lawful things that We have provided you with, and be grateful to Allah, if it is indeed He Whom you worship}. 4173. He has forbidden you only the Maitah (dead animals), and blood, and the flesh of swine, and that which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah. But if one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing due limits, then there is no sin on him. Truly, Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Command to eat Pure Things and the Explanation of the Prohibited Things Allah commands His believing servants to eat from the pure things that He has created for them and to thank Him for it, if they sire truly His servants.

Eating from pure sources is a cause for the acceptance of supplications and acts of worship, just as eating from impure sources prevents the acceptance of supplications and acts of worship, as mentioned in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad, that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: it 'ja 2>l 013 i 2)1 ty l\$» o>Lju m 1£

470 Tafcir Ibn Kathir i^l'j>- itjj U . jj Ij : ^LL^J ! JI 4jJj «1>1>«L1j ii-^3 l f4^ “-v^’J ‘f’S5” “J «0 people! Allah is Tayyib (Pure and Good) and only accepts that which is Tayyib. Allah has indeed commanded the believers with what He has commanded the Messengers, far He said: 40 (you) Messengers! Eat of the Tayyibdt and do righteous deeds. Verily, I am well-acquainted with what you do) (23:51), and: 40 you who believe! Eat of the lawful things that We have provided you ivith) He then mentioned a mem, *who is engaged in a long journey, whose hair is untidy and who is covered in dust, he raises his hands to the sky. and says, 'O Lord! O Lord!' Yet, his food is from the unlawful, his drink is from the unlawful, his clothes are from the unlawful, and he was nourished by the unlawful, so hozo can it (his supplication) be accepted?!”*! It was also recorded by Muslim and At- Tirmidhi 121 After Allah mentioned how He has blessed His creatures by providing them with provisions, and after commanding them to eat from the pure things that He has provided them, He then stated that He has not prohibited anything for them, except dead animals. Dead animals are those that die before being slaughtered; whether they die by strangling, a violent blow, a headlong fall, the goring of horns or by being partly eaten by a wild animal. Dead animals of the sea are excluded from this ruling, as is explained later, Allah willing, as Allah said: 4Lawful to you is (the pursuit of) watergame and its use far food) (5:96), and because of the Hadith about the whale recorded in the SahihP The Musnad, Al-Muwatta’ and the Sunan recorded the Prophet saying about the sea: «i=U jJlj JjLi > 111 Ahmad 3:328. Muslim 2 :703 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :333 131 Fath Al-Bari 6 : 152

Its water is pure and its dead are permissible Ash-Shafit, Ahmad, Ibn Majah, and Ad-Daraqutni reported that Ibn “Umar said that the Prophet jg said: “JUULj 1S3I; dLLDl cdHij o&U 0 lWe have been allowed two dead things and hoo bloody things fish and locusts; and liver and spleetv>.^ We will mention this subject again in Surat Al-Ma’idah (chapter 5 in the Qur’an), In sha’ Allah (if Allah wills). Issue: According to Ash-Shafil and other scholars, milk and eggs that are inside dead unslaughtered animals are not pure, because they are part of the dead animal. In one narration from him, Malik said that they are pure themselves, but become impure because of their location. Similarly, there is a difference of opinion over the cheeses (made with the milk) of dead animals. The popular view of the scholars is that it is impure, although they mentioned the fact that the Companions ate from the cheeses made by the Magians (fire worshippers). Hence, Al-Qurtubi commented: “Since only a small part of the dead animal is mixed with it, then it is permissible, because a minute amount of impurity does not matter if it is mixed with a large amount of liquid.”,3) Ibn Majah reported that Salman said that Allah’s Messenger was asked about butter, cheese and fur. He said: >f <ci- L“j U ^ -ui J^~l Li J’iUJln Mi. U, tThe allowed is what Allah has allowed in His Book and the prohibited is what Allah has prohibited in His Book. What He has not mentioned is a part ofwhat He has pardoned .s|4 Allah has prohibited eating the meat of swine, whether *** Ahmad 5:365, Al-Muwatta’ 1:22, Abu Dawud 1:64, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 1 : 224, An-Nasa’i 1 :50, and Ibn Majah 1 :136. Tarttb Musnad Ash-Shafi’i 2 :173 , Ahmad 2 :97 , Ibn Majah 2 :1073 Ad-Daraqutni 4 :272 131 Al-Qurtubi 2:221. ‘ Ibn Majah 2:1117.

472 Tafsir Ibn Kathir slaughtered or not, and this includes its fat, either because it is implied, or because the term Lahm includes that, or by analogy. Similarly prohibited are offerings to other than Allah, that is what was slaughtered in a name other than His, be it for monuments, idols, divination, or the other practices of the time of Jahiliyyah. Al-Qurtubi mentioned that 'A'ishah was asked about what non-Muslims slaughter for their feasts and then offer some of it as gifts for Muslims. She said, "Do not eat from what has been slaughtered for that day, (or feast) but eat from their vegetables." The Prohibited is Allowed in Cases of Emergency Then Allah permitted eating these things when needed for survival or when there are no permissible types of food available. Allah said: iBut if one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing due limits meaning, without transgression or overstepping the limits, i...then there is no sin on him.)> meaning, if one eats such items, for, *»' iTruly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Mujahid said, "If one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing the set limits. For example, if he didn't, then he would have to resort to highway robbery, rising against the rulers, or some other kinds of disobedience to Allah, then the permission applies to him. If one does so transgressing the limits, or continually, or out of disobedience to Allah, then the permission does not apply to him even if he is in dire need." The same was reported from Said bin Jubayr. Said and Muqatil bin Hayyan are reported to have said that without willful disobedience means, "Without believing that it 1,1 Al-Qurtubi 2:224.

473 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (150 - 174) (Part-2 is permissible."11 ' It was reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah: 4 ...without willful disobedience nor transgressing^ saying, "Without willful disobedience means eating the dead animal and not continuing to do so. Qatadah said: 4without willful disobedience^ "Without transgressing by eating from the dead animals, that is when the lawful is available."2' Issue: When one in dire straits finds both— dead animals, and foods belong to other people which he could get without risking the loss of his hands or causing harm, then it is not allowed for him to eat the dead animals. Ibn Majah reported that 'Abbad bin Shurahbil Al-Ghubari said, "One year we suffered from famine. I came to Al-Madlneh and entered a garden. I took some grain that I cleaned, and ate, then I left some of it in my garment. The owner of the garden came, roughed me up and took possession of my garment. I then went to Allah's Messenger and told him what had happened. He said to the man: «Yom have not fed him when he was hungry - or he said starving - nor have you taught him if he was ignorant . The Prophet jg commanded him to return 'Abbad's garment to him, and to offer him a Wasq (around 180 kilograms) - or a half Wasq - of food'3' This has a sufficiently strong chain of narrators and there are many other witnessing narrations to support it, such as the Hadith that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb narrated from his father that his grandfather said: Allah's Messenger jg was asked about the hanging clusters of dates. He said: 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :236. 121 At-Tabari 3:324. '3| Ibn Majah 2:770.

aT?iere is no hann for whoever takes some of it in his mouth for a necessity without putting it in his garment .»[1 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan commented on: jjii '«i' 6} U . . .then there is no sin on him. Truly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. "For what is eaten out of necessity."*2 ' SaTd bin Jubayr said, "Allah is pardoning for what has been eaten of the unlawful, and Merciful' in that He allowed the prohibited during times of necessity."3 ' Masrtiq said, "Whoever is in dire need, but does not eat or drink until he dies, he will enter the Fire."*4 ' This indicates that eating dead animals for those who are in need of it for survival is not only permissible but required. Vi itij* & 'ii In Vi jjiiSv §iii&&&

't&k% :viii it^ 4 'y=,jVJt Je. Lj vitJcilij ojjt kilpJjl 4 ^ Vyiiifljl 4 tjkhlt ;/Jji £>tj 4»«it i-'-feil' Jj-j ii' C>1j liM'i 4174. Verily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book, and purchase a small gain therewith (of ivorlddy things), they eat into their bellies nothing but fire. Allah will not speak to them on the Day of Resurrection, nor purify them, and theirs will be a painful torment}. 4175. Those are they who have purchased error at the price of guidance, and torment at the price offorgiveness . So how bold they are (for evil deeds which will push them) to the Fire}. 4176. That is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. And verily, those who disputed as regards the Book arefar away in opposition}. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:510. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:240. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :240 ' Al-Bayhaqi in AsSunan Al-Kubra 9 :357

Criticizing the Jews for concealingwhat Allah revealed Allah said: t t{ } iVerily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book.} Meaning the Jews who concealed their Book's descriptions of Muhammad sg, all of which testify to his truth as a Messenger and a Prophet. They concealed this information so that they would not lose authority and the position that they had with the Arabs, where they would bring them gifts, and honor them. The cursed Jews feared that if they announced what they know about Muhammad jg, then the people would abandon them and follow him. So they hid the truth so that they may retain the little that they were getting, and they sold their souls for this little profit. They preferred the little that they gained over guidance and following the truth, believing in the Messenger jg and having faith in what Allah was sent him with. Therefore, they have profited failure and loss in this life and the Hereafter. As for this world, Allah made the truth about His Messenger jg known anyway, by the clear signs and the unequivocal proofs. Thereafter, those whom the Jews feared would follow the Prophet jg, believed in him and followed him anyway, and so they became his supporters against them. Thus, the Jews earned anger on top of the wrath that they already had earned before, and Allah criticized them again many times in His Book. For instance, Allah said in this Ayah (2:174 above): Q . A J. jjr iVerily, those who conceal what Allah has sent down of the Book, and purchase a small gain therewith (ofworldly things).} meaning, the joys and delights of this earthly life. Allah said: ^ ijift u 3J\$} i-. they eat into their bellies nothing but fire.} meaning, whatever they eat in return for hiding the truth, will turn into a raging fire in their stomachs on the Day of Resurrection. Similarly, Allah said:

4^ ^ 3\$ o^4 1\$ {Verily, those who unjustly eat up the property of orphans, they eat up only fire into their bellies, and they will be burnt in the blazing Fire!} (4:10) Also, reported in an authentic Hadith is that Allah's Messenger sg said: tp^r j\l J 'yr'M4 lSV L'X j\ JS'l; uTltose who eat or drink in golden or silver plates are filling their stomachs with the fire ofjaltannam (Hell)M li Allah said: {j~^ }y. \$Allah will not speak to them on the Day of Resurrection, nor purify them, and theirs will be a painful torment.} This is because Allah is furious with them for concealing the truth. They thus deserve Allah's anger, so Allah will not look at them or purify them, meaning that He will not praise them but will cause them to taste a severe torment. Then, Allah said about them: US)'& bM {Those are they who have purclwsed errorfor guidance.} Hence, they opposed the guidance, that is, not announcing the Prophet's description they find in their Books, the news about his prophecy and the good news of his coming which the previous Prophets proclaimed, as well as following and believing in him. Instead, they preferred misguidance by denying him , rejecting him and concealing his descriptions that were

mentioned in their Books. Allah said: { . . .and torment at the price offorgiveness,} meaning, they preferred torment over forgiveness due to the I 1 ' Sahih Al-Bukhtui no . 5634, and Muslim no. 2065.

477Surah 2. Al-Baaarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) sins they have committed. Allah then said: 4So how bold they are (for evil deeds which will push them) to the Fire> Allah states that they will suffer such severe, painful torment that those who see them will be amazed at how they could bear the tremendous punishment, torture and pain that they will suffer. We seek refuge with Allah from this evil end. Allah's Statement: imm tv aap 'j Wyo'jj A !~—=r^gjj \j jj'_) 4JJL c-{j <-£> JLJ' i&Ali ^ 5 oUljtj 1 Stei£f& **' **'" ^ tSA-fi-l,^»4UayJ (iil'j (ji—»A> djl j£ - -1 gpoyiiij .?* r< . -t 255£i\$ £\$£> 41»uW (JCyW UJuc iThat is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. means, they deserve this painful torment because Allah has revealed Books to His Messenger Muhammad s\$, and the Prophets before him, and these revelations bring about truth and expose falsehood. Yet, they took Allah's signs for mockery. Their Books ordered them to announce the truth and to spread the knowledge, but instead, they defied the knowledge and rejected it. This Final Messenger — Muhammad jg — called them to Allah, commanded them to work righteousness and forbade them from committing evil. Yet, they rejected, denied and defied him and hid the truth that they knew about him. They, thus, mocked the Ayat that Allah revealed to His

Messengers, and this is why they deserved the torment and the punishment. This is why Allah said here (2:176): iThat is because Allah has sent down the Book (the Qur'an) in truth. And verily, those who disputed about the Book are far away in opposition.} jit 'jf l£ij y>IJj3 Jr* 1Ay o' jJ' ^4 \$\$ y)j {jSf.lIJlj iii JLi jlij JtjJ' Ijl *JtiM «— J— 1' ^Wcj*-" iiUJjij glil ^Vif Jy^y u 4177 . It is not Birr that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west; but Birr is the one who believes in Allah, the Last Day, the Angels, the Book, the Prophets and gives his ioealth, in spite of love for it, to the kinsfolk, to the orphans, and to Al- Masdkfn (the poor), and to the wayfarer, and to those who ask, and to set servants free, performs As-Saldh (Iqdmah-As-Saldh) and gives the Zakdh, and who fulfill their covenant when they make it, and ivho are patient in extreme poverty and ailment (disease) and at the time offighting (during the battles). Such are the people of the truth and they are Al-Muttaqun (the pious).} Al-Birr (Piety, Righteousness) This Ayah contains many great wisdoms, encompassing rulings and correct beliefs. As for the explanation of this Ayah, Allah first commanded the believers to face Bayt Al-Maqdis, and then to face the Ka'bah during the prayer. This change was difficult for some of the People of the Book, and even for some Muslims. Then Allah sent revelation which clarified the wisdom behind this command, that is, obedience to Allah, adhering to His commands, facing wherever He commands facing, and implementing whatever He legislates, that is the objective. This is Birr, Taqwa and complete faith. Facing the east or the west does not necessitate righteousness or obedience, unless it is legislated by Allah. This is why Allah said:

,>*' o* jj' !\$> Ar^ 1 ' &i bb> o' </f is not Birr that you h/m your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers); but Birr is the one who believes in Allah and the Last Day,} Similarly, Allah said about the sacrifices: 4It is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, but it is the pietyfrom you that reaches Him.} (22:37) Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "The Jews used to face the west for their Qiblah, while the Christians used to face the east for their Qiblah. So Allah said: Jj \jy o' jii 411 is not Birr that you turn your faces towards east and (or) west (in prayers)} (2:177) meaning, "this is faith, and its essence

requires implementation.” Similar was reported from Al-Hasan and Ar-Rabi‘ bin AnasJ Ath-Thawri recited: ibut Birr is the one who believes in Alldlt,} and said that what follows are the types of Birr.*21 He has said the truth. Certainly, those who acquire the qualities mentioned in the Ayah will have indeed embraced all aspects of Islam and implemented all types of righteousness; believing in Allah, that He is the only God worthy of worship, and believing in the angels the emissaries between Allah and His Messengers. The “Books’ are the Divinely revealed Books from Allah to the Prophets, which were finalized by the most honorable Book (the Qur’an). The Qur’an supercedes all previous Books, it mentions all types of righteousness, and the way to happiness in this life and the Hereafter. The Qur’an abrogates all previous Books and testifies to all of Allah’s Prophets, from the first Prophet to the Final Prophet, Muhammad, may Allah’s l1 ‘ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :251 ‘ Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :253

peace and blessings be upon them all. Allah’s statement: & <30 4...and gives his wealth, in spite of lovefor it,} refers to those who give money away while desiring it and loving it. It is recorded in the Sahihayn that Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet said: «The best charity is when you give it away while still healthy and thrifty, hoping to get rich andfearing poverty." Allah said: V, fL, jfj «3il -fidu - l(Jj t-jy i <!f <\$• Oy^vf} 4And they give food, inspite of their love for it, to the Miskin (the poor), the orphan, and the captive (saying) : "We feed you seeking Allah's Face only. We wish for no reward, nor thanks from you."} (76:8, 9) and: &&<L\ 4By no means shall you attain Birr unless you spend of that which you love.} (3:92) Allah’s statement: 4 . . .and give them preference over thetmselves even though they were in need ofthat} (59:9) refers to a higher category and status, as the people mentioned here give away what they need, while those mentioned in the previous Ayat give away what they covet (but not necessarily need). Allah’s statement: 4Jj^ \ <sf} 4the kinsfolk} refers to man’s relatives, who have more rights Fath Al-Bari 3 :334 , and Muslim 2 :716

481Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) than anyone else to one’s charity, as the Hadith supports: ^j \ t <dLu?j 4jXu? *jwl l j t aSjlJ? ^lp 4jXu2.ll 8 iL ^01 ^Sadaqah (i.e., charity) given to the poor is a charity, while the Sadaqah given to the relatives is both Sadaqah and Silah (nurturing relations), for they are the most deserving of you and your kindness and charih/®. 11 ‘ Allah has commanded kindness to the relatives in many places in the Qur’an. 4to the orphans} The orphans are children who have none to look after them, having lost their fathers while they are still young, weak and unable to find their own sustenance since they have not reached the age ofwork and adolescence. ‘Abdur- Razzaq reported that ‘Ali said that the Prophet jg said: <*\$*3!> iand to Al-Masakin} The Mishin is the person who does not have enough food, clothing, or he has no dwelling. So the Miskin should be granted the provisions to sustain him enough so that he can acquire his needs. In the Sahthayn it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah’s Messenger jg said: tjtuiUij a j, ^jji . tijiaii ^ . ti JLkui 3 v’j i ^sizJ i jfij “The Miskin is not the person who roams around, and whose need is met by one or two dates or one or two bites. Rather, the Miskin is he who does not have what is sufficient, and to whom the people do not pay attention and, thus, do not give himfrom the charity.*12 iand to the wayfarer} is the needy traveler who runs out of money and should, thus, be granted whatever amount that Ahmad 4 :214. Fath Al-B&ri3 :399 , and Muslim 2:719.

helps him to go back to his land. Such is the case with whoever intends to go on a permissible journey, he is given what he needs for his journey and back. The guests are included in this category. ‘Ali bin

Abu Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Ibn As-Sabil (wayfarer) is the guest who is hosted by Muslims.”¹¹ Furthermore, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu JaTar Al-Baqir, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri, Ar- Rabl‘ bin Anas and Muqatil bin Hayyan said similarly.¹² iZ&xfr iattd to those who ask> refers to those who beg people and are thus given a part of the Zakah and general charity. iand to set servantsfree} These are the servants who seek to free themselves, but cannot find enough money to buy their freedom. We will mention several of these categories and types under the Tafsir of the Ayah on Sadaqah in Surat Bara’ah [chapter 9 in the Qur’an], In sha’ Allah. Allah’s statement: iperfbnnns As-Salah (IqdmAt-As-Saldh)} means those who pray on time and give the prayer its due right; the bowing, prostration, and the necessariy attention and humbleness required by Allah. Allah’s statement: iand gives the Zakah} means the required charily {Zakah) due on one’s money, as Said bin Jubayr and Muqatil bin Hayyan have stated.¹³ ' Allah’s statement: iand who fulfill their covenant when they make it,} 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :259. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :260 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :264

483Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) is similar to: '<*&•. u *»' *>jjt cyl'r iTItose zoho fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the Mithdq (bond, treaty, covenant).} (13:20) The opposite of this characteristic is hypocrisy. As found in a Hadith: t . aL>- jpj 1i)^ t bl : v^^Aj aJU “77ie signs o/ a hypocrite are three: if he speaks, he lies; if he promises, he breaks his promise; and if he is entrusted, he breaches the fn/sfV In another version: lilji jJL(JL*U lilj iJLijS lil 11 Ifhe speaks, he lies; if he vows, lie breaks his voio; and if he disputes, he is lewd.d2] Allah’s statement: 4 ...and who are patient in extreme poverty and ailment (disease) and at the time offighting (during the battles).} means, during the time of meekness and ailment. s&} 4 .. .and at the time offighting (during the battles).} means on the battlefield while facing the enemy, as Ibn Mas’ud, Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Murrah Al-Hamdani, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Abu MalikJ3 ' Ad- Dahhak and others have stated. 141 And calling them the patient here, is a form >f praise, because of the importance of patience in these circumstances, and the suffering and difficulties that accompany them. And m Muslim 1 :78. 121 Ibid. [3] Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :270-271 141 At-Tabari 3:355.

Allah knows best, it is He Whom help is sought from, and upon Him we rely. Allah’s statement: S S * +* **• < J V j’jll italjiy iSuch are the people of the truth means, whoever acquires these qualities, these are truthful in their faith. This is because they have achieved faith in the heart and realized it in deed and upon the tongue. So they are the truthful, iatui they are Al-Muttaqiin (the pious). because they avoided the prohibitions and performed the acts of obedience. S3 aty &VS £&}£\$ >; 4 && sr* o; <£jj s>_ o; /J 4^ ‘j;*- 4 ,’va*. Xj> J£* xJ dsxii <27S. O you who believe! Al-Qisas (the Law of equality) is prescribed far you in case of murder: the free far the free, the slave far the slave, and the female far the female. But if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood money), then it should be sought in a good manner, and paid to him respectfully. Tltis is an alleviation and a mercyfrom your Lord. So after this, whoever transgresses the limits (i.e. kills the killer after taking the blood money), he shall have a painful torment.} 4179. And there is (a saving of) life far you in Al-Qisas (the Law of equality in punishment), O men of understanding, that you may acquire Taqwd.} The Command and the Wisdom behind the Law of Equality Allah states: O believers! The Law of equality has been ordained on you (for cases of murder), the free for the free, the slave for the slave and the female for the female. Therefore, do

485 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) not transgress the set limits, as others before you transgressed them, and thus changed what Allah has ordained for them.

The reason behind this statement is that (the Jewish tribe of)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 485–502]

Banu An-Nadlr invaded Qurayzah (another Jewish tribe) during the time of JahUiyyah (before Islam) and defeated them. Hence, (they made it a law that) when a person from Nadir kills a person from Quraizah, he is not killed in retaliation, but only pays a hundred IVasq of dates. However, when a person from Quraizah kills a Nadir man, he would be killed for him. If Nadir wanted (to forfeit the execution of the murderer and instead require him) to pay a ransom, the Quraizah man pays two hundred Wasq of dates [double the amount Nadir pays in Diyah (blood money)]. So Allah commanded that justice be observed regarding the penal code, and that the path of the misguided and mischievous persons be avoided, who in disbelief and transgression, defy and alter what Allah has commanded them. Allah said: # ys fcii 4 ^ 4Al-Qisds (the Law of equality in punishment) is prescribed for you in case of murder: the free for the free, the slave for the slave, and thefemalefor thefemale.} Allah's statement: ivii £35 iff» 4the free for the free, the slave for the slave, and the female for thefemale.} was abrogated by the statement {life for life) (5:45). However, the majority of scholars agree that the Muslim is not killed for a disbeliever whom he kills. Al- Bukhari reported that 'Ali narrated that Allah's Messenger sgj; said: (J—4 ifek y iThe Muslim is not killed for the disbeliever (whom he kills),a'21 No opinion that opposes this ruling could stand correct, nor is there an authentic Hadith to contradict it. However, Abu I 1 * A camel load, sixty Sa', approximately 165 liters. ^ SahOi Al-Bukharino . 111.

Hanifah thought that the Muslim could be killed for a disbeliever, following the general meaning of the Ayah (5:45) in Surat Al-Ma'idah (chapter 5 in the Qur'an). The Four Imams (Abu Hanifah, Malik, Shafil and Ahmad) and the majority of scholars stated that the group is killed for one person whom they murder. 'Umar said, about a boy who was killed by seven men, "If all the residents of San'a' (capital of Yemen today) collaborated on killing him, I would kill them all." No opposing opinion was known by the Companions during that time which constitutes a near Ijma' (consensus). There is an opinion attributed to Imam Ahmad that a group of people is not killed for one person whom they kill, and that only one person is killed for one person. Ibn Al-Mundhir also attributed this opinion to Mu'adh, Ibn Az-Zubayr, 'Abdul-Malik bin Marwan, Az-Zuhri, Ibn Sirin and Habib bin Abu Thabit. Allah's statement: iBut if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood money), then it should be sought in a good manner, and paid to him respectfully refers to accepting blood money (by the relatives of the victim in return for pardoning the killer) in cases of intentional murder. This opinion is attributed to Abu Al-'Aliyah, Abu Sha'tha', Mujahid, Sa'Id bin Jubayr, 'Ata' Al-Hasan, 11 Qatadah12 ' and Muqatil bin Hayyan.131 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said: 4 it} tie iBut if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood moneyfo means the killer is pardoned by his brother (i.e., the relative of the victim) and accepting the Diyah after capital punishment becomes due (against the killer), this is the 'Afw (pardon mentioned in the Ayah).”141 Allah's statement: 111 Ibn Abi flatim 1 : 278-279. At-Tabari 3 :368. Ibn AbiHatim 1:279. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :280.

4 ...then it should be sought in a good manner,} means, when the relative agrees to take the blood money, he should collect his rightful dues with kindness: di 4 and paid to him respectfully.} means, the killer should accept the terms of settlement without causing further harm or resisting the payment. Allah's statement: 4This is an alleviation and a mercy from your Lord.} means the legislation that allows you to accept the blood money for intentional murder is an alleviation and a mercy from your Lord. It lightens what was required from those who were before you, either applying capital punishment or forgiving. Sa'id bin Mansur reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, The Children of Israel were required to apply the Law of equality in murder cases and were not allowed to offer pardons (in return for blood money). Allah said to this Ummah (the Muslim nation): && £2i«# JSK 4 4The Law of equality in punishment is prescribed for you in case of murder : the free for the free, the servant for the servant, and the female for the female. But if the killer is forgiven by the brother (or the relatives) of the killed (against blood money),} Hence, 'pardoning' or 'forgiving' means accepting blood money in intentional murder cases."111 Ibn Hibban also recorded this in his Sahib.'21 Qatadah said: 4^ 111 Sunan Sa'id bin Mansur 2 :652 121 Ibn Hibban 7 :601

iThis is an alleviation from your Lord^ Allah had mercy on this Ummah by giving them the Diah which was not allowed for any nation before it. The People of the Torah (Jews) were allowed to either apply the penal code (for murder, i.e., execution) or to pardon the killer, but they were not allowed to take blood money. The People of the Injil (the Gospel - the Christians) were required to pardon (the killer, but no Diah was legislated). This Ummah (Muslims) is allowed to apply the penal code (execution) or to pardon and accept the blood money." Similar was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas. Allah's statement: 4.*-^ Jjo i!(jCii j, 4S0 after this lohever transgresses the limits, he shall have a painful torment.} means, those who kill in retaliation after taking the Diah or accepting it, they will suffer a painful and severe torment from Allah. The same was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ata' 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan.*2' The Benefits and Wisdom of the Law of Equality Allah's statement: 4And there is life for you in Al-Qisas legislating the Law of equality, i.e., killing the murderer, carries great benefits for you. This way, the sanctity of life will be preserved because the killer will refrain from killing, as he will be certain that if he kills, he would be killed. Hence life will be preserved. In previous Books, there is a statement that killing stops further killing! This meaning came in much clearer and eloquent terms in the Qur'an: iw- 4P& [1! Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :274-275. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :278-279.

muz TA mm .{''f-v-r j?f5* " --f?. ?.-fr _r" ! <&. ov> 0 / ^ WSsJ'J.s *''l{£ ""***>{* . >\ \ *.*'£ \>AjJji^bi^bj C^^^yyScfcS >JlAjLjJlIi ^L<3l)~ j)^jL>A lJk«~*-Ly^ ^5-X-^J 1 <W *r r ^ *» >^:r O? oJ_*5 L-va^^U^==3(lraJ 4» X^=cJj;Lj \ ijj^y;^i\ pLcolj^pjJJ' a_jfrjt—o^iv_w_j—i(jli (_jC'ti5aL_At ^ 4 1_): :>^-. "i.^ 4Araf there is (a saving of) life for you in Al- Qisas (the Law of equality in punishment) .> Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "Allah made the Law of equality a 'life'. Hence, how many a man who thought about killing, but this Law prevented him from killing for fear that he will be killed in turn." Similar statements were reported from Mujahid, Sa'id bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and Muqatil bin Hayyan.* 11 Allah's statement: ^ ^Vf dM iO men of understanding, that you may acquire Taqwd.\$ means, 'O you who have sound minds, comprehension and understanding! Perhaps by this you will be compelled to refrain from transgressing the prohibitions of Allah and what He considers sinful.' Taqwa (mentioned in the Ayah) is a word that means doing all

acts of obedience and refraining from all prohibitions. CwyV'j Lj» Aj oj. 'ij ii' uj Uf& ,<*', /klr> CjZ IL. jjA*' Alii aAc pti tlij j! l_aj* a°j* {j)^£. (1| Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :290-292

490 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4#^ 4180. It is prescribed for you, when death approaches any of you, if he leaves wealth, that he makes a bequest to parents and next of kin, according to reasonable manners. (This is) a duty upon Al-Muttaqin (the pious) 4181 . Then whoever changes it after hearing it, the sin shall be on those who make the change. Tndy, Allah is All-Hearer, All- Knower.} 4182. But he who fears from a testator some unjust act or wrongdoing, and thereupon he makes peace between the parties concerned, there shall be no sin on him. Certainly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful Including Parents and Relatives in the Will was later abrogated This Ayah contains the command to include parents and relatives in the will, which was obligatory, according to the most correct view, before the Ayah about inheritance was revealed. When the Ayah of inheritance was revealed, this Ayah was abrogated, so fixed shares of the inheritance for deserving recipients were legislated by Allah. Therefore, deserving inheritors take their fixed inheritance without the need to be included in the will or to be reminded of the favor of the inherited person. For this reason we see the Hadith narrated in the Sunan and other books that ‘Amr bin Kharijah said: I heard Allah’s Messenger 5^ saying in a speech: t ajo- J?. Ji 41)1 ijj *Allah has given each heir his fixed share. So there is no will far a deserving heir.^ 1] Imam Ahmad recorded that Muhammad bin Sirin said: Ibn ‘Abbas recited Surat Al-Baqarah (chapter 2 in the Qur’an) until he reached the Ayah: 1\$, '-£* AJ o)> m TlthfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :313 , An-Nasa’i 6 :247 , and Ibn Majah 2 :905

491Surah 2. Al-Bagarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) 4...if he leaves wealth, that he makes a bequest to parents and next of kin.} He then said, “This Ayah was abrogated.” This was recorded by Said bin Mansur and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak* 1 ' Al- Hakim Said, “It is Sahih according to their criteria (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)”. Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement: 4a bequest to parents and next of kin} was abrogated by the Ayah iThere is a share for men and a share for women from what is left by parents and those nearest related, whether the property be small or large - a legal share.} (4:7) Ibn Abu Hatim then said, “It was reported from Ibn Umar, Abu MQsa, Said bin Musayyib, Al-Hasan, Mujahid, ‘Ata’ Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Sirin,121 ‘Ikrimah,131 Zayd bin Aslam and Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas. Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan,141 Tawtts,151 Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Shurayh, Ad-Dahhak and Az-Zuhri said that this Ayah (2:180 above) was abrogated by the Ayah about the inheritors (4:7). The Will for the Relatives that do not qualify as Inheritors It is recommended that the remaining relatives who do not have a designated fixed share of the inheritance, be willed up to a third, due to the general meaning of the Ayah about the will. It is recorded in the \$ahtyayn that Ibn Umar said that Allah’s Messengerm said: Said bin MansOr 2 :663 , and Al-Hakim 2 :273 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 301-302. At-Jabari 3:391. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :302-303. 151 At-Tabari 3:389. 161 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 303.

• *fjj Yl jiiLJ ^ (*j ****'4 JcSy ^ (J>" ^*D “ft is not permissible for any Muslim who has something to will to stay for two nights witlwut having his last will and testament written and kept ready with him . Ibn “Umar commented, “Ever since I heard this statement from Allah’s Messenger no night has passed, but my will is kept ready with me.” There are many other Ayat and AhadXth ordering kindness and generosity to one’s relatives. The Will should observe Justice The will should be fair, in that one

designates a part of the inheritance to his relatives without committing injustice against his qualified inheritors and without extravagance or stinginess. It is recorded in the Sahihayni2] that Sa'd bin Abu Waqqas said, "O Allah's Messenger! I have some money and only a daughter inherits from me, should I will all my remaining property (to others)?" He said, "No." Sa'd said, "Then may I will half of it?" He said, "No." Sa'd said, "One- third?" He said, "Yes, one-third, yet even one-third is too much. It is better for you to leave your inheritors wealthy than to leave them poor, begging from others." Al-Bukhari mentioned in his Sahih that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I recommend that people reduce the proportion of what they bequeath by will to a fourth (of the whole legacy) rather than a third, for Allah's Messenger jg said: . , > > k "One-third yet even one-third is too mwc/i.®"131 Allah's statement: \ Jr? 'l j* ,<*J 1 U*]i Ujjj j, {j+iy iTheti whoever changes it after hearing it, the sin shall be on those who make the change. Truly, Allah is All-Hearer, All- Knower.\$ Fath Al-B&ri 5 :419 , and Muslim 3 :1249 and 1250 121 Fath Al-Bari 5 :724, and Muslim 3 :1250. Sahih Al-Bukh&ri no. 2743

493 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) means, whoever changed the will and testament or altered it by addition or deletion, including hiding the will as is obvious, then ithe sin shall be on those who make the change.} Ibn 'Abbas and others said, "The dead person's reward will be preserved for him by Allah, while the sin is acquired by those who change the will."111 ipya iTruly, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} means, Allah knows what the dead person has bequeathed and what the beneficiaries (or others) have changed in the will. Allah's statement: 4&1 j\ l_j£ '£>} 4But he who fears from, a testator some unjust act or wrongdoing,} Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and As-Suddi said, "Error."121 These errors include such cases as when the inheritor indirectly acquires more than his fair share, such as by being allocated that a certain item mentioned in the legacy be sold to him. Or, the testator might include his daughter's son in the legacy to increase his daughter's share in the inheritance, and so forth. Such errors might occur out of the kindness of the heart without thinking about the consequences of these actions, or by sinful intention. In such cases, the executive of the will and testament is allowed to correct the errors and to replace the unjust items in the will with a better solution, so that both the Islamic law and what the dead person had wished for are respected and observed. This act would not constitute an alteration in the will and this is why Allah mentioned it specifically, so that it is excluded from the prohibition (that prohibits altering the will and testament) mentioned in the m At-Tabari 3:397. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :310-31 1

494 Tafoir Ibn Katlirir previous Ayah. And Allah knows best. The Virtue of Fairness in the Will 'Abdur-Razzaq reported that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah's Messenger jg said: ' vj? (PA jil JUu Jp) ji^Jl 0!^ ^ ^131 Jii Slj . jtl\ ji.G i*Ui- ^L. «J • (_*? "A man might perform the works of righteous people for seventy years, but when he dictates his will, he commits injustice and thus his ivorks end with the worst ofhis deeds and he enters the Fire. A man might perform the works of evil people for seventy years, but then dictates a just will and thus ends with the best ofhis deeds and then enters Paradise.» Abu Hurayrah then said, "Read ifyou wish: Jjii- iThese are the limits ordained by Allah, so do not transgress them.)' (2:229) ;&j fi-ft & cr fo» cjf ip: -yji pk)> d*JP A-f ju* jl pA lilil ,v\r'jjiu > it \yy^ai jlJ 4J PjiaJ pLaJo A-JJj jOyLLjj /jil ^183. O you who believe! Fasting is prescribed for you as it was prescribed for those before you, that you may acquire Taqwa.} 4184. Fast for a fixed number of days, but ifany ofyou is ill or on a journey, the same number (should be made up) from other days. And as for those who can fast with difficulty, (e.g., an old man), they have (a choice either to fast or) to feed a Miskin (poor

person) (for every day) . But whoever does good of his own accord, it is better for him . And that you fast is better ‘Abdur-Razzaq 9 :88.

495 Surah 2. Al-Baarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) far you if only you know fa The Order to Fast In an address to the believers of this Ummah, Allah ordered them to fast, that is, to abstain from food, drink and sexual activity with the intention of doing so sincerely for Allah the Exalted alone. This is because fasting purifies the souls and cleanses them from the evil that might mix with them and their ill behavior. Allah mentioned that He has ordained fasting for Muslims just as He ordained it for those before them, they being an example for them in that, so they should vigorously perform this obligation more obediently than the previous nations. Similarly, Allah said: *z 4 j&p; ft & ft! y; -fafa QZ fcfa j' 'yJJI* 4 To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way. If Allah had willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you; so compete in good deeds fa (5:48) Allah said in this Ayah: 40 you who believe! Fasting is prescribed for you as it was prescribed for those before you, that you may have Taqwd) fa since the fast cleanses the body and narrows the paths of Shaytan. In the Sahthayn the following Hadith was recorded: *j gjjLii ^.'l fa .—jIIAJI 'j U»* «0 young people! Whoever amongst you can afford marriage, let him marry. Whoever cannot afford it, let him fast, for it will be a shield for him fo Allah then states that the fast occurs during a fixed number of days, so that it does not become hard on the hearts. m Fath Al-Bdri 9 :8 , and Muslim 2:1018.

497 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) (for every day).} “It means “those who find it difficult (to fast).’ Formerly, those who wished, fasted and those who wished, did not but fed a poor person instead.” Allah then said: *iBut whoever does good of his own accord* meaning whoever fed an extra poor person, *u'j fi iit* is better for him. And that you fast is better for you} Later the Ayah: *'jEi\ feL* <So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month} (2:185) was revealed and this abrogated the previous Ayah (2:184). The Fidyah (Expiation) for breaking the Fast is for the Old and the Ailing Al-Bukhari reported that ‘Ata heard Ibn ‘Abbas recite: <5 /kjjLlu 4 And as for those who can fast with difficulty, (e.g., an old man), they have (a choice either to fast or) to feed a Miskin (poor person) (for every day).} Ibn ‘Abbas then commented, “(This Ayah) was not abrogated, it is for the old man and the old woman who are able to fast with difficulty, but choose instead to feed a poor person for every day (they do not fast).”² Others reported that Said bin Jubayr mentioned this from Ibn ‘Abbas. So the abrogation here applies to the healthy person, who is not traveling and who has to fast, as Allah said: *4*I^i* 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :28 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:28.

498 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4 So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month> (2:185) As for the old man (and woman) who cannot fast, he is allowed to abstain from fasting and does not have to fast another day instead, because he is not likely to improve and be able to fast other days. So he is required to pay a Fidyah for every day missed. This is the opinion of Ibn ‘Abbas and several others among the Salaf who read the Ayah: 4 And as for those who can fast with difficulty, (e.g., an old man)} to mean those who find it difficult to fast’ * as Ibn Mas‘ud stated. This is also the opinion of Al-Bukhari who said, “As for the old man (person) who cannot fast, (he should do like) Anas who, for one or two years after he became old fed some bread and meat to a poor person for each day he did not fast.”² This

point, which Al-Bukhari attributed to Anas without a chain of narrators, was collected with a continuous chain of narrators by Abu Ya'la Mawsuli in his Musnad, that Ayyub bin Abu Tamimah said; "Anas could no longer fast. So he made a plate of Thand (broth, bread and meat) and invited thirty poor persons and fed them."*3 * The same ruling applies for the pregnant and breast-feeding women if they fear for themselves or their children or fetuses. In this case, they pay the Fidyah and do not have to fast other days in place of the days that they missed. J ££ "Ij J* CTJ jJClj Xji c: # *4^j; -;ij: ^ lj, %^ £=» a 4185. The month of Ramadan in which was revealed the Qur'an, a guidance for mankind and clear proofs for the m At-Tabari 3:431. * FathAl-Bari 8:179. * MusnadAbu Ya'la 7:204.

499Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 guidance and the criterion (between right and wrong). So whoever of you sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sazom (fasting) that month, and whoever is ill or on a journey, the same number [of days which one did not observe Sazom (fasting) must be made up] from other days. Allah intends for you ease, and He does not zoant to make things difficult for you. (He wants that you) must complete the same number (of days), and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takhir (Alldhu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)] for having guided you so that you may be grateful to Him.} TheVirtue ofRamadan and the Revelation oftheQur'an in it. Allah praised the month of Ramadan out of the other months by choosing it to send down the Glorious Qur'an, just as He did for all of the Divine Books He revealed to the Prophets. Imam Ahmad reported Wathilah bin Al-Asqa' that Allah's Messenger jg said: jja aLJ Jjl ^ f „_ ff y * ^ t ljU •oLiij CJ>- «The Suhuf (Pages) of Ibrahim were revealed during the first night of Ramadan. Tire Torah was revealed during the sixth night of Ramadan. The Injil was revealed during the thirteenth night of Ramadan. Allah revealed the Qur'an on the tzenty- fourth night ofRamadan .» The Virtues ofthe Qur'an Allah said: 4...a guidance for mankind and clear proof for the guidance and the criterion (between right and wrong).} Here Allah praised the Qur'an, which He revealed as Ahmad 4:107.

guidance for the hearts of those who believe in it and adhere to its commands. Allah said: 4and clear proofs meaning, as clear and unambiguous signs and unequivocal proof for those who understand them. These proofs testily to the truth of the Qur'an, its guidance, the opposite of misguidance, and how it guides to the straight path, the opposite of the wrong path, and the distinction between the truth and falsehood, and the permissible and the prohibited. The Obligation ofFastingRamadan Allah said: jflii fen 4So whoever ofyou sights (the crescent on the first night of) the month (of Ramadan, i.e., is present at his home), he must observe Sawm (fasting) that month.)> This Ayah requires the healthy persons who witness the beginning of the month, while residing in their land, to fast the month. This Ayah abrogated the Ayah that allows a choice of fasting or paying the Fidyah. When Allah ordered fasting, He again mentioned the permission for the ill person and the traveler to break the fast and to fast other days instead as compensation. Allah said: 4...and whoever is ill or on a journey, the same number [of days which one did not observe Sawm (fasting) must be made up]from other days.} This Ayah indicates that ill persons who are unable to fast or fear harm by fasting, and the traveler, are all allowed to break the fast. When one does not fast in this case, he is obliged to fast other days instead. Allah said: 4S—^ j^=»J -irij lit 4Alldh intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficultfor you

501 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) This Ayah indicates that Allah allowed such persons, out of His mercy and to make matters easy for them, to break the fast when they are ill or traveling, while the fast is still obligatory on the healthy persons who are not traveling. Several Rulings concerning the Fast The authentic Sunnah states that Allah's Messenger ﷺ traveled during the month of Ramadan for the battle for Makkah. The Prophet ﷺ marched until he reached the area of Kadid and then broke his fast and ordered those who were with him to do likewise. This was recorded in the Two Sahibs.¹¹¹ Breaking the fast mentioned in this Hadith was not required, for the Companions used to go out with Allah's Messenger ﷺ during the month of Ramadan, then, some of them would fast while some of them would not fast and neither category would criticize the others. If the command mentioned in the Hadith required breaking the fast, the Prophet ﷺ would have criticized those who fasted. Allah's Messenger himself sometimes fasted while traveling. For instance, it is reported in the Two Sahibs that Abu Ad-Darda' said, "We once went with Allah's Messenger ﷺ during Ramadan while the heat was intense. One of us would place his hand on his head because of the intense heat. Only Allah's Messenger and 'Abdullah bin Rawahah were fasting at that time."²¹ We should state that observing the permission to break the fast while traveling is better, as Allah's Messenger said about fasting while traveling: «Those who did not fast have done good, and there is no harm for those who fasted»³¹ In another Hadith, the Prophet ﷺ said: «Ho/d to Allah's permission that He has granted you."¹⁴¹ Fath Al-Bari 3:213, Muslim 2 :784 121 Fath Al-Bari 4 :2 15 , and Muslim 2 :790 131 Muslim 2:790. 141 Muslim 2:786.

Some scholars say that the two actions are the same, as 'A'ishah narrated that Hamzah bin 'Amr Al-Aslami said, "O Messenger of Allah! I fast a lot, should I fast while traveling?"

The Prophet said: Hi jp ijUiuHi jl» Fast if you wish or do not fast if you wish. This Hadith is in the Two Sahibs. It was reported that if the fast becomes difficult (while traveling), then breaking the fast is better. Jabir said that Allah's Messenger saw a man who was being shaded (by other people while traveling). The Prophet ﷺ asked about him and he was told that man was fasting. The Prophet said: .«>DIJ fCJl 'J\ >3» «It is not a part of Birr (piety) to fast while traveling .# This was recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.¹²¹ As for those who ignore the Sunnah and believe in their hearts that breaking the fast while traveling is disliked, they are required to break the fast and are not allowed to fast. As for making up for missed fasting days, it is not required to be consecutive. One may do so consecutively or not consecutively. There are ample proofs to this fact. We should mention that fasting consecutive days is only required exclusively during Ramadan. After the month of Ramadan,

what is required then is to merely make up for missed days.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 502–512]

This is why Allah said: /1 *' { mm X \ 4>' a* ^ 4...the same number (should be made up) from other days.} Base and not Hardship Allah then said: 4Allah intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficult for you .} 1 1] Fath Al-Bari 4:211, and Muslim 2 :789 121 Fath Al-Bari 4 :216, and Muslim 2 :786.

503 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Imam Ahmad recorded Anas bin Malik saying that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: uTreat the people with ease and don't be hard on them; give them glad tidings and

don't fill them with aversion . This Hadvth was also collected in the Two Sahihs)] ^ It is reported in the Sahthayn that Allah's Messenger said to Mu'adh and Abu Musa when he sent them to Yemen: Vj Ic-jlLjj S IjZ-jj tlycj Y “Trail the people with ease and don't be hard on them; give them glad tidings and don't fill them with aversion; and love each other, and don't differ .»|2 The Sunan and the Musnad compilers recorded that Allah’s Messenger jfc; said: oJLJ «/ was sent with the easy Hattffiyyah (Islamic Monotheism).^ Allah’s statement: .u\ ijfaj fa ±4%^fa iii jl;> 4Allah intends for you ease, and He does not want to make things difficult for you (He wants that you) must complete the same number (ofdays)} means: You were allowed to break the fast while ill, while traveling, and so forth, because Allah wanted to make matters easy for you. He only commanded you to make up for missed days so that you complete the days of one month. Remembering Allah upon performing the Acts of Worship Allah’s statement: ^ - '%& 111 Ahunad 3 :13 1 , and 209 , Fath Al-Bari 10 :54 1 , and Muslim 3 :1359 |2! Fath Al-Bari 7 :660 , Muslim 3 : 1587 Ahmad 5 :266

4...and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takbir (Allahu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)]forhaving guided you£ means: So that you remember Allah upon finishing the act of worship. This is similar to Allah’s statement: 4So when you have accomplished your Mandsik, (rituals) remember Allah as you remember your forefathers or with far more remembrance (2:200) and: i -IT jJS« IjSZfj j yUrt 4...Then when the (Jumu'ah) Saldh (prayer) is ended, you may disperse through the land, and seek the bounty of Allah (by working), and remember Allah much, that you may be successful. (62:10) and: 4 -- and glorify the praises ofyour Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting. And during a part of the night, glorify His praises, and after the prayers.> (50:39, 40) This is why the Sunnah encouraged Tasbih (saying Subhan Allah, i.e., all praise is due to Allah), Tahmid (saying Al-Hamdu Lillah, i.e., all the thanks are due to Allah) and Takbir (saying Allahu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Great) after the compulsory prayers. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “We used to know that Allah’s Messenger jfe has finished the prayer by the Takbir.”01 Similarly, several scholars have stated that reciting Takbir the during ‘Id-ul-Fitrwas specified by the Ayah that states: isi ljuj£=cJj •jLjll ^ 4(He wants that you) must complete the same number (of days), and that you must magnify Allah [i.e., to say Takbir (Allahu Akbar: Allah is the Most Great)] for having guided m Sahih Al-Bukharino . 842

505Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 Allah’s statement: i...so that you may be grateful to Him.) means: If you adhere to what Allah commanded you, obeying Him by performing the obligations, abandoning the prohibitions and abiding by the set limits, then perhaps you will be among the grateful. il86. And when My servants ask you (O Muhammad jg concerning Me, then ansiver them), I am indeed near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant when he calls on Me (without any mediator or intercessor). So let them obey Me and believe in Me, so that they may be led aright.} Allah hears the Servant’s Supplication Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari said, “We were in the company of Allah’s Messenger during a battle. Whenever we climbed a high place, went up a hill or went down a valley, we used to say, ‘Allah is the Most Great,’ raising our voices. The Prophet came by us and said: ujj iQu ij jUii bji-x i 'ji. 1^31 l'i ^ 'sWb 3* Cri J! 4O'* (jail jj Oji-Xi '*H V4% v ?&ji it ^ xj. «0 people! Be merciful to yourselves (i.e., don't raise your voices), for you are not calling a deafor an absent one, but One Who is All-Hearer, All-Seer. The One Whom you call is closer to one ofyou than the neck ofhis animal. O 'Abdullah bin Qais (Abu Musa’s name) should I teach you a

statement that is a treasure of Paradise : 'La hawla wa la quwwata ilia billah (there is no power or strength except from Allah).'111 » (i) Ahmad 4 :402

507 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Imam Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger said: —i^ : J_ji ij><j jiJU sL>V*LLjO "One's supplication will be accepted as long as he does not become haughty and say, 'I have supplicated but it has not been accepted from me.'"®' This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihahs from Malik, and this is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Muslim recorded that the Prophet said: j\ pii i Jij _Lj j' ^ ^ Jiji 7 Jyuj : Jj laj ijil Opj Zf-Ci 'J 4- "The supplication of the servant will be accepted as long as he does not supplicate for what includes sin, or cutting the relations of the womb, and as long as he does not become hasty.* He was asked, "O Messenger of Allah! How does one become hasty?" He said, «He says, 'I supplicated and supplicated, but I do not see that my supplication is being accepted from me.' He thus loses interest and abandons supplicating (to Allah). Three Persons Whose Supplication will not be rejected In the Musnad of Imam Ahmad and the Sunans of At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasai and Ibn Majah it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger said: ;y-'ij Ji- j fiWi -. 'r+pi ij 7 • 11 {jt? jJJ "Three persons will not have their supplication rejected: the just ruler, the fasting person until breaking the fast, and the supplication of the oppressed person, for Allah raises it above the clouds on the Day of Ahmad 2:396. 121 Fatty Al-Bari 1 1 : 145, and Muslim 4 :2095 Muslim 4 :2096

V, ti*in&'cffi 1p^&c-J'<&P£>£a (J==i~Ji>\ £=S 4'^^ -ai ^ ^ .jgflV&K j difcj^tl^tfyu'jli JitJJji rl&J r^ ^ \ JilijJl*!!^ ^ ^LoJ^t to;l3Jy.1 jjiIJ**lj^j'jo;^l'i*^Vij?3li^V ,^2-3*1 {«} ;£>jl_illt._L->4'5^it^C^j-l^~l^J Tafsir 7b» KfIOir Resurrection, and the doors of heaven will be opened for it, and Allah says, 'By My grace! / ti>»7/ certainly grant it for you, even if after a while. 'I ££' &j ,U»J £5 £Q £ Ji ihsC>\ (*i«• o4 J'Q v£ ,£=J^ [y£j> iAiJr? opt !&£S [&P& C^=> u * jgflm £ *k &]U A _fZ& &)S~& 4*5^ Z&4 % 44' Ol ftt J£; 4 o^ 4-sr ^ ;,r ^412 ojua **a;& *±g. 4fcd^& 4187. It is made lawful for you to have sexual relations with your wives on the night of As-Siyam (fasting). They are Libas [i.e., body-cover, or screen] for you and you are Libas for them. Allah knows that you used to deceive yourselves, so He turned to you (accepted your repentance) and forgave you So now have sexual relations with them and seek that which Allah has ordained for you (offspring), and eat and drink until the white thread (light) of dawn appears to you distinct from the black thread (darkness of night), then complete your fast till the nightfall. And do not have sexual relations with them (your 111 Ahmad 3:544, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :229, and Ibn Mfijah 1 :557

wives) while you are in I'tikaf in the Masjids. These are the limits (set) by Allah, so approach them not. Thus does Allah make clear His Ayat to mankind that they may acquire Taqwd.} Eating, Drinking and Sexual Intercourse are allowed during the Nights of Ramadan These Ayat contain a relief from Allah for the Muslims by ending the practice that was observed in the early years of Islam. At that time, Muslims were allowed to eat, drink and have sexual intercourse only until the 'Isha.' (Night) prayer, unless one sleeps before the Isha prayer. Those who slept before 'Isha' or offered the 'Isha' prayer, were not allowed to drink, eat or sexual intercourse until the next night. The Muslims found that to be difficult for them. The Ayat used the word Rafath ' to indicate sexual intercourse, according to Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ata' and Mujahid. Similar Tafsir was offered by Said bin Jubayr, Tawus, Salim bin 'Abdullah, 'Amr bin Dinar, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Az-Zuhri, Ad-Dahhak, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, As-Suddi, 'Ata' Al-

Khurasani and Muqatil bin Hayyan. Allah said: ilti sq pjp sq iThey are Libds [i.e., body-cover, or screen] for you and you are Libdsfor them.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah means, “Your wives are a resort for you and you for them.”*21 Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas said, “They are your cover and you are their cover. In short, the wife and the husband are intimate and have sexual intercourse with each other, and this is why they were permitted to have sexual activity during the nights of Ramadan, so that matters are made easier for them. Abu Ishaq reported that Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib said, “When the Companions of Allah’s Messenger jg observed fast but would sleep before breaking their fast, they would continue fasting Ibn Abi Hatim 1 : 367-371 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :370. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1:371.

iVtfe AAlldh knows that you used to deceive yourselves, so He turned to you (accepted your repentance) and forgave you. So noio have sexual relations with them}" This is the same narration that Al-‘Awfi related from Ibn ‘Abbas . 1 ’ Allah said: ip ’if a A -.and seek that which Allah has ordained far you (offspring),} Abu Hurayrah, Ibn ‘Abbas, Anas, Shurayh Al-Qadi, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ata’, Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam, Hakam bin ‘Utbah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Al- Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, and others said that this Ayah refers to having offspring . Qatadah said that the Ayah means, “Seek the permission that Allah has allowed for you.” Said narrated that Qatadah said, ip if u Aand seek that which Allah has ordainedfar you,} Time for Suhur Allah said: Oi # 2>' Of££ it £ £L;£ I^ifj \jt& i . . .and eat and drink until the white thread (light) of dawn appears to you distinct from the black thread (darkness of night), then complete yourfast till the nightfall.} Allah has allowed eating and drinking, along with having sexual intercourse, as we have stated, during any part of the night until the light of dawn is distinguished from the darkness of the night. Allah has described that time as ‘distinguishing the white thread from the black thread.’ He At-Tabari 3 :496-498. Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :377-378, and At-Tabari 3 :506-507.

then made it clearer when He said: iofdawn.} As stated in a Hadith that Imam Abu ‘Abdullah Al-Bukhari recorded, Sahl bin Sa’d said, “When the following verse was revealed: i>pi\ «&i\ J£ii£ £L;£ iEat and drink until the white thread appears to you, distinct from the black thread and \$ofdawn} was not revealed, some people who intended to fast, tied black and white threads to their legs and went on eating till they differentiated between the two. Allah then revealed the words, iofdawn}, and it became clear to them that it meant (the darkness of) night and (the light of) day.” Al-Bukhari recorded that Ash-Shahi said that ‘Adi said, “I took two strings, one black and the other white and kept them under my pillow and went on looking at them throughout the night, but could not make any distinction between the two. So, the next morning I went to Allah’s Messenger and told him the whole story. He said: aYour pillow is very wide if the white and black threads are under if/» Some wordings for this Hadith read, «Your Qafa (back side ofyour neck) is wide/»’3 ’ Some people said that these words meant that ‘Adi was not smart. This is a weak opinion. The narration that Al-Bukhari collected explains this part of the Hadith. Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Adi bin Hatim narrated: I said, “O Messenger of Allah!

What is the white thread from the black thread? Are they

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 512–523]

m FathAl-Bari 8:31. 121 Ibid. 131 Ibid.

523 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 actual threads?" He said: jdt Siji j: i : jti p o>:i' M uiiii ify «VoHr Qafd is wide if you see the two threads. Rather, they are the blackness of the night and the whiteness of the daylight Suhur[^] is recommended Allah allowed eating and drinking until dawn, it represents proof that Suhur is encouraged, since it is a Rukhsah (concession or allowance) and Allah likes that the Rukhsah is accepted and implemented. The authentic Sunnah indicates that eating the Suhur is encouraged. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Anas narrated that Allah's Messenger said: "Eat the Suhur, for there is a blessing in Suhur . Muslim reported that 'Amr bin Al-'As narrated that Allah's Messenger said: !l iiS'l ~ej li U jl> uTlie distinction between our fast and the fast of the People of the Book is the meal of Suhur. Imam Ahmad reported that Abu Said narrated that Allah's Messenger jg said: iu I jli jl jij itjf-Jj 'fi 'SJt <JL? 1 ifi- 0^4 «Suhur is a blessed meal. Hence, do not abandon it, even if one just takes a sip of water. Indeed, Allah and His angels send Saldh (blessings) upon those who eat Suhur. »,5) There are several other Hadiths that encourage taking the m Ibid. 121 Fath Al-Bari 4 : 165 and Muslim 2 :770. Muslim 2:771. Ahmad 3 :44 ^ Predawn meal taken before fasting.

Suhur, even if it only consists of a sip of water. It is preferred that Suhur be delayed until the time of dawn. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Anas bin Malik narrated that Zayd bin Thabit said, "We had Suhur with Allah's Messenger jg and then went on to pray." Anas asked, "How much time was there between the Adhan (call to prayer) and the Suhur?" He said, "The time that fifty Ayat take (to recite)." Imam Ahmad recorded Abu Dharr saying that Allah's Messenger jg said: I \jiJyfi' U ^l>u *My Ummah ivill always retain goodness as long as they hasten in breaking the fast and delay the Suhiir.^2] There are several Hadlths that narrate that the Prophet jEr, called Suhur "the blessed meal." There are narrations from several of the Salaf that they allowed the Suhur to be eaten later until close to Fajr. This is reported from Abu Bakr, 'Umar, 'Ali, Ibn Mas'fld, Hudhayfah, Abu Hurayrah, Ibn 'Umar, Ibn 'Abbas and Zayd bin Thabit. It is also reported from many of the Tabi'in, such as Muhammad bin 'Ali bin Husayn, Abu Mijlaz, Ibrahim An- Nakhal, Abu Ad-Duha, Abu Wa'il and other companions of Ibn Mas'ud. This is also the opinion of 'Ata', Al-Hasan, Hakam bin TJyainah, Mujahid, 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr, Abu Sha*tha' Jabir bin Zayd, Al- A'mash and Ma'mar bin Rashid. We have mentioned the chains of narrations for their statements in our (Ibn Kathlr's) book about Siyam (Fasting), and all praise is due to Allah. It is also recorded in the Two Sahihs that Al-Qasim said that 'A'ishah narrated that Allah's Messenger jg said: r>- ljl£> iJ~L ^ S/ t <77ie Adhan pronounced by Bilal should not stop you from taking Suhur, for he pronounces the Adhan at night. Hence, eat and drink until you hear the Adhan by Ibn Umm Maktiim, Fath Al-Bari 4 :164 and Muslim 2 :771 ,21 Ahmad 5:147.

515 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 for he does not call the Adhan until daion.^ ^ This is the wording collected by Al-Bukhari. Imam Ahmad reported that Qays bin Talq quoted from his father that Allah's Messenger jg said: "Dawn is not the (ascending) gloio of white light of the horizon. Rather, it is the red (radiating) light. Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi also recorded this Hadlth, but their wording is: & \jX> «Eat and drink and do not be rushed by the ascending (white) light. Eat and drink until the redness (of the dawn) appears Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari) recorded that Samurah bin Jundub narrated that Allah's Messenger said: li* Vj J% jlil p&fu V" "Do not be stopped by Bilal's Adhan or the (ascending) whiteness, until it spreads.*^ Muslim also recorded this Hadith) S] There is no Harm in beginning the Fast while Junub (a state of major ritual impurity) Issue: Among the benefits of allowing sexual activity, eating and drinking until dawn for those who are fasting, is that it is allowed to start the fast while

Junub (in the state of impurity after sexual discharge), and there is no harm in this case if one takes a bath any time in the morning after waking up, and completes the fast. This is the opinion of the Four Imams and the majority of the scholars. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that ‘A’ishah and Umm Salamah said that Allah’s ﷻ Fath Al-Bari 4 :162 , and Muslim 2 :768 Ahmad 4:23. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3 :389 141 At-Tabari 3:517. Muslim 2:769.

“The people will retain goodness as long as they hasten in breaking the fast” 1 ﷻ Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said: 8Allah the Exalted said, ‘The dearest among My servants to Me are those who hasten in breaking the fast the most’»|2 At-Tirmidhi recorded this Hadith and said that this Hadith is Hasan Gharib. Prohibition of Uninterrupted Fasting (Wisdl) There are several authentic Hadiths that prohibit Al-Wisdl, which means continuing the fast through the night to the next night, without eating. Imam Ahmad recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that Allah’s Messenger ﷺ said: o*’ JI {ML J^U —iJ “Do not practice Al-Wisdl in fasting .» So, they said to him, “But you practice Al-Wisdl, O Allah’s Messenger!” The Prophet ﷺ replied, “ «/ am not like you, I am given food and drink during my sleep by my Lord. So, when the people refused to stop Al-Wisdl, the Prophet ﷺ fasted two days and two nights (along with those who practiced Wisdl) and then they saw the crescent moon (of the month of Shawwal). The Prophet ﷺ said to them (angrily): J^i ‘fo *If the crescent had not appeared, I would have made you fast for a longer period.» That was as a punishment for them (when they refused to stop practicing Al-Wisdl).*4 ' This Hadith is also recorded in the Sahihayn. Fath Al-Bari 4 : 234 and Muslim 2 :771 Ahmad 2:237. [31 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:386. Ahmad 2 :281 , Fath Al-Bari 4 : 238 , and Muslim 2 :774

519 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 iAttd do not have sexual relations with them (your wives) while you are in I'tikdf in the Masjids meaning, ‘Do not touch your wives as long as you are in I'tikdf, whether you were in the mosque or outside of it’.” ' It is also the opinion of Mujahid, Qatadah and several other scholars, that the Muslims used to have sexual intercourse with the wife while in I'tikdf if they departed the mosque until the Ayah was revealed.121 Ibn Abu Hatim commented, “It was reported that Ibn Mas'ud, Muhammad bin Ka*b, Mujahid, ‘Ata’ Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl* bin Anas and Muqatil said that the Ayah means, ‘Do not touch the wife while in I'tikdf’”13' What Ibn Abu Hatim reported from these people is the agreed upon practice among the scholars. Those who are in I'tikdf are not allowed to have sexual intercourse as long as they are still in I'tikdf in the mosque. If one has to leave the mosque to attend to a need, such as to relieve the call of nature or to eat, he is not allowed to kiss or embrace his wife or to busy himself with other than his I'tikdf He is not even allowed to visit ailing persons, but he can merely ask about their condition while passing by. I'tikdf has several other rulings that are explained in the books (of Fiqh), and we have mentioned several of these rulings at the end of our book on Siyam (Fasting), all praise is due to Allah. Furthermore, the scholars of Fiqh used to follow their explanation of the rules for fasting with the explanation of the rules for I'tikdf, as this is the way these acts of worship were mentioned in the Qur'an. By mentioning I'tikdf after fasting, Allah draws attention to practicing I'tikdf during the month of the fast, especially the last part of the month. The Sunnah of Allah’s Messenger is that he used to perform I'tikdf during the last ten nights of the month of Ramadan until he died. Afterwards, the Prophet’s wives used to perform I'tikdf as the Two Sahihs recorded from ‘A’ishah the Mother of the believers.141 IM At-Tabari 3 :541 121 At-Tabari 3:541. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :385-387. Fath Al-Bari 4 :318 and Muslim 2 :831

It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Safiyyah, the daughter of Huyal, went to Allah's Messenger ﷺ to visit him in the mosque while he was in I'tikaf. She had a talk with him for a while, then she got up in order to return home. The Prophet ﷺ accompanied her back home, as it was night. Her house was at Usamah bin Zayd's house on the edge of Al-Madlnah. While they were walking, two Ansari men met them and passed by them in a hurry, for they were shy to bother the Prophet ﷺ while he was walking with his wife. He told them: *J? I\jJ i USU-'-j* "Do not run away! She is (my wife) Safiyyah bint Huyai.v Both of them said, "All praise is due to Allah, (How dare we think of any evil) O Allah's Messenger!" The Prophet ﷺ said (to them): *: JIS j\ *Shaytan reaches everywhere in the human body, that the blood reaches. I was afraid lest Shaytan might suggest an evil thought in your minds .o'* 11 Imam Ash-Shafit commented, "Allah's Messenger ﷺ sought to teach his Ummah to instantly eliminate any evil thought, so that they do not fall into the prohibited. They (the two Ansari men) had more fear of Allah than to think evil of the Prophet ﷺ. Allah knows best." The Ayah (2:187) prohibits sexual intercourse and anything like kissing or embracing that might lead to it during I'tikaf. As for having the wife helping the husband, it is allowed. It is reported in the Two Sahllis that 'A'ishah said, "Allah's Messenger ﷺ would bring his head near me (in her room) and I would comb his hair, while I was on my menses. He would enter the room only to attend to what a man needs. |2' Allah's statement: Fath Al-Bari4 :326 and Muslim 4:1712. FathAl-Bari4 :320 and Muslim 1 :244

521 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) iThese are the limits (set) by Allah} means, This is what We have explained, ordained, specified, allowed and prohibited for fasting. We also mentioned the fast's objectives, what is permitted during it, and what is required of it. These are the set limits that Allah has legislated and explained, so do not come near them or transgress them.' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "(Allah's set limits mentioned in the Ayah) mean these four limits (and he then recited): }It is made lawful for you to have sexual relations with your wives on the night of As-Siydm (fasting).} and he recited up to: 4^ % foi& '£} it then complete your Sawm (fast) till the nightfall.} My father and other's used to say similarly and recite the same Ayah to us." Allah said: }Thus does Allah make clear His Aydt to mankind} meaning, 'Just as He explains the fast and its rulings. He also explains the other rulings by the words of His servant and Messenger, Muhammad j£.' Allah continues: 4to mankind that they may attain Taqwq.} meaning, 'So that they know how to acquire the true guidance and how to worship (Allah).' Similarly, Allah said: ill ub Jpl j*, kl' c£)f_ oil. I.J ge. Jjv! y,} it is He Who sends down manifest Aydt to His servant (Muhammad jg) that He may bring you out from (types of) darkness into the light. And verily, Allah is to you full of kindness, Most Merciful.} (57:9)

oi '- "J* I4J Jiiill jJSIT j^Jyl ijKt5 4:j£5#s o-vilf 4188. And eat up not one another's property unjustly (in any illegal way, e.g., stealing, robbing, deceiving), nor give bribery to the rulers (judges before presenting your cases) tltat you may knowingly eat up a part of the property of others sinfully.> Bribery is prohibited and is a Sin 'Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This [Ayah 2:188] is about the indebted person when there is no evidence of the loan. So he denies taking the loan and the case goes to the authorities, even though he knows that it is not his money and that he is a sinner, consuming what is not allowed for him."! ' This opinion was also reported from Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As- Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayan and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. They all stated, "Do not dispute when you know that you are being unjust. ",21 The Judge's Ruling does not allow the Prohibited or prohibit the Lawful It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Umm

Salamah narrated that Allah's Messenger said: oi (*£-***; 'j*-; Ui) Via j\ IfL-Alb ijU ja aJ A» til t_r"! «/ am only human! You people present your cases to me, and as some of you may be more eloquent and persuasive in presenting his argument, I might issue a judgment in his benefit. So, if I give a Muslim's right to another, I am really giving him a piece offire; so he should not take tfV3 The Ayah and the Hadith prove that the judgment of the At-Tabari 3:550. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :393-394, and At-Tabari 3 : 550-551 [31 Fath Al-Bari 13 :190 , and Muslim 3 :1373

523Surah 2. Al-Bagaralt (175 authorities in any case does not change the reality of the truth. Hence, the ruling does not allow what is in fact prohibited or prohibit what is in fact allowed. It is only applicable in that case. So if the ruling agrees with the truth, then there is no harm in this case. Otherwise, the judge will acquire his reward, while the cheater will acquire the evil burden. This is why Allah said: Jyl oi ijijj py] %} y'i's. iAtid eat up not one another's property unjustly, nor give bribery to the rulers (judges before presenting your cases) that you may knowingly eat up a part of the property of others sinfully.) meaning, "While you know the falsehood of what you claim.' Qatadah said, "O son of Adam! Know that the judge's ruling does not allow you what is prohibited or prohibit you from

what is allowed. The judge only rules according to his best

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 523–527]

judgment and according to the testimony of the witnesses. The judge is only human and is bound to make mistakes. Know that if the judge erroneously rules in some one's favor, then that person will still encounter the dispute when the disputing parties meet Allah on the Day of Resurrection. Then, the unjust person will be judged swiftly and precisely with that which will surpass whatever he acquired by the erroneous judgment he received in the life of this world. 'j>15 «jL Jjj(JliJj Ji 3* \$\$} ifll \jluXj \$ St —:— Cr* j l&J Ji y.\ 4189. They ask you (O Muhammad) about the crescents. Say: "These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind and for the pilgrimage." It is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness, etc.) that you enter the houses from the back, but Al-Birr is from Taqwd. So enter houses through their proper doors, and have Taqwa ofAllah that you may be successful.) At-Tabari 3 :550

The CrescentMoons Al-'Awfl related that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The people asked Allah's Messenger 2§ about the crescent moons. Thereafter, this Ayahwas revealed: iThey ask you (O Muhammad) about the crescents. Say, "These are signs to markfixed periods of timefor mankind...) so that they mark their acts of worship, the 'Iddah (the period of time a divorced woman or a widow is required to wait before remarrying) of their women and the time of their Hajj (pilgrimage to Makkah)."1 ' 1 ' Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn TJmar narrated that Allah's Messenger said: p-* Jill J*?- a ijiii "Allah has made the crescents signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind. Hence, fast on seeing it (the crescent for Ramadan) and break the fast on seeing it (the crescent for Shawwal). If it (the crescent) was obscure to you then count thirty days (mark that month as thirty days)ji2] This Hadlth was also collected by Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak, and he said, "The chain is Sahth, and they (Al- Bukhari and Muslim) did not recorded it." Righteousness comes from Taqwa Allah said: ift ->*\$ Oi Ljgf \$5 ot iJf ilt is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness, etc.) that you enter the houses from the back, but Al-Birr is from Taqwa. So enter houses through their proper doors.) Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara' said, "During the time of At-Tabari 3:554. ' Abdur-Razzaq 4 : 156 131 Al-Hakim 1 :423.

525 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Jahiliyyah, they used to enter the house from the back upon assuming the Hiram. Thereafter, Allah revealed (the following Ayah): *hi. ^4' \$5 cA\$m ot \$5 oL ilt* is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness, etc.) that you enter the houses from the back but Al-Birr is from Taqwa. So enter houses through their proper doors. Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded the same Hadith from Al- Bara' but with the wording; "The Ansar used to enter their houses from the back when returning from a journey. Thereafter, this Ayah (2:189 above) was revealed..."*2 ' Al-Hasan said, "When some people during the time of Jahiliyyah would leave home to travel, and then decide not to travel, they would not enter the house from its door. Rather, they would climb over the back wall. Allah the Exalted said: *4 Oi iib jfJl SQjfr ill* is not Al-Birr (piety, righteousness) that you enter the houses from the back,}.'™ Allah's statement: *i...and have Taqwa of Allah that you may be successful. Have Taqwa of Allah, means to do what He has commanded you and refrain from what He has forbidden for you, i that you may be successful> tomorrow when you stand before Him and He thus rewards you perfectly.* 4-s4 ** %ftg\$ JL 4 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:310. Musnad At-Tayalisi, 98. * Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :40 1

J mm r mm 1' > •' •• * > t ?* * > A'.M l *" -f-' -f- <—:»" (»* > " ! » * // > ^ 4 , -v/ ' / > ! * > ' y * " i l p A ^ C \$ \ d* 4. ^ / < ' V / . < # / • > . • i - ' a » < fiif j . c Jjoys-3 J VJ ^ J ^ ; j j A £ -4) i » o j i l _ y £ » - j A ^ k . ' A s ^ e ^ ! ^ \$ 4 « l S) i i i l ! - ^ . (^ i > * ^ v S - | . * > Y - f ? " ! ' < , f * * . . { ' < ' I J * > 4 * ' f y 1 * * < j ^ ' j f < ' j t t , * ' v l j ^ i S j ' l * * r ~ U j j i * ' i » ' r t < * " " o A y o j S - H t j - & J ' j m " & I j ^ u f j j i 4 ! * < 4 ^ ' < 190. And fight in the way of Allah those who fight you, but transgress not the limits. Truly, Allah likes not the transgressors.} And kill them wherever you find them, and turn them out from where they have turned you out. And Al-Fitnah is worse than killing. And fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-Haram (the sanctuary at Mak- kah), unless they (first fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them. Such is the recompense of the disbelievers.} 4192. But if they cease, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4193. And fight them until there is no more Fitnah (disbelief and worshipping of others along with Allah) and the religion (all and every kind of worship) is for Allah (Alone). But if they cease, let there be no transgression except against Az-Zalim (the polytheists and wrongdoers.} The Command to fight Those Who fight Muslims and killing Them wherever They are found Abu Jafar Ar-Razi said that Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said that Abu Al-'Aliyah commented on what Allah said: *4 £ J i & u & \$ 4 ' f o & f }*

527 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) *4 And fight in the way of Allah those who fight you,}* Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "This was the first Ayah about fighting that was revealed in Al-Madinah. Ever since it was revealed, Allah's Messenger jg used to fight only those who fought him and avoid non-combatants. Later, Surat Bara'ah (chapter 9 in the Qur'an) was revealed." 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said similarly, then he said that this was later abrogated by the Ayah: *, 4 then kill them wherever you find them}* (9:5). However, this statement is not plausible, because Allah's statement: *. . _ u - a \}* 4 . . . those who fight you} applies only to fighting the enemies who are engaged in fighting Islam and its people. So the Ayah means, 'Fight those who fight you', just as Allah said (in another Ayah): *4 . . and fight against the Mushrikin collectively as they fight against you collectively> ' (9:36)* This is why Allah said later in the Ayah: *. . # > • (- • > \ 4 And kill them wherever you find them, and turn them out from where they have turned you out.}* meaning, Your energy should be spent on fighting them, just as their energy is spent on fighting you, and on expelling them from the areas from which they have expelled you, as a law of equality in punishment.'

530 Tafsir Ibn Kathir «Whoever closed his door is safe. Whoever entered the (Sacred) Mosque is safe. Whoever entered the house of Abu Sufyan is also safe. Allah said: 4...unless they (first) fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them. Such is the recompense of the disbelievers.} Allah states: Do not fight them in the area of the Sacred Mosque unless they start fighting you in it. In this case, you are allowed to fight them and kill them to stop their aggression.’ Hence, Allah’s Messenger took the pledge from his Companions under the tree (in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah) to fight (the polytheists), after the tribes of Quraysh and their allies, Thaqif and other groups, collaborated against the Muslims (to stop them from entering Makkah to visit the Sacred House). Then, Allah stopped the fighting before it started between them and said: 4And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them .} (48:24) and: iJ >3 ^Lj) Ojr£ ji Djlc- - j Ij tjJ JJ iLLJ .aj***zj ^ 4Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills — if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have punished those of them who disbelieved with painful torment.} (48:25) Allah’s statement: & fy 0 111 Ahmad 2 :292

531 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) iBut if they cease, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} which means, ‘If they (polytheists) cease fighting you in the Sacred Area, and come to Islam and repent, then Allah will forgive them their sins, even if they had before killed Muslims in Allah’s Sacred Area.’ Indeed, Allah’s forgiveness encompasses every sin, whatever its enormity, when the sinner repents it. The Order to fight until there is no more Fitnah Allah then commanded fighting the disbelievers when He said: y&} i...until there is no more Fitnah} meaning, Shirk. This is the opinion of Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Al- ‘Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi‘, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi and Zayd bin Aslam. ’ 1 Allah’s statement: i . . .and the religion (all and every kind of worship) is for Allah (Alone).} means, ‘So that the religion of Allah becomes dominant above all other religions.’ It is reported in the Two Sahihis that Abu Musa Al-Ash‘ari said: "The Prophet was asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! A man fights out of bravery, and another fights to show off, which of them fights in the cause of Allah?’ The Prophet said: «<ii LLoi^ i’ JkS j j:U He who fights so that Allah’s Word is superior, then he fights in Allah’s cause. in addition, it is reported in the Two Sahihis: .Jill V) ii) y I fijK J>- ,>&! ^ •£>>!» 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :415-416. m Fath Al-Bari 13 :450 and Muslim 3:1513.

533 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) Allah’.” Under Allah’s statement: iAnd fight them until there is no more Fitnah} Al-Bukhari recorded that Nafi‘ said that two men came to Ibn ‘Umar during the conflict of Ibn Az-Zubayr and said to him, “The people have fallen into shortcomings and you are the son of Umar and the Prophet’s Companion. Hence, what prevents you from going out?” He said, “What prevents me is that Allah has forbidden shedding the blood of my (Muslim) brother.” They said, “Did not Allah say: 4 4£2 -i £\$&>} iAnd fight them until there is no more Fitnah (disbelief and worshipping of others along with Allah)}?” He said, “We did fight until there was no more Fitnah and the religion became for Allah Alone. You want to fight until there is Fitnah and the religion becomes for other than Allah!” TJthman bin Salih added that a man came to Ibn ‘Umar and asked him, “O Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman! What made you perform Hajj one year and ‘Umrah another year and abandon Jihad in the cause of Allah, although you know how much He has encouraged performing it?” He said, “O my nephew! Islam is built on five (pillars): believing in Allah and His Messenger, the five daily prayers,

fasting Ramadan, paying the Zakah and performing Hajj (pilgrimage) to the House.” They said, “O Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman! Did you not hear what Allah said in His Book: iAnd if two parties (or groups) among the believers fall to fighting, then make peace between them both. But if one of them outrages against the other, then fight you (all) against the one that which outrages till it complies with the command of Allah.} (49:9) and: HI At-Tabari 3 :573

4’Ei ojG v 4A«rffight them until there is no more Fittah (disbelief)?} He said, “That we did during the time of Allah’s Messenger when Islam was still weak and (the Muslim) man used to face trials in his religion, such as killing or torture. When Islam became stronger (and apparent), there was no more Fitnah.” He asked, “What do you say about ‘Ali and TJthman?” He said, “As for ‘Uthman, Allah has forgiven him. However, you hated the fact that Allah had forgiven him! As for ‘Ali, he is the cousin of Allah’s Messenger jg and his son-in-law.” He then pointed with his hand, saying, “This is where his house is located (meaning, ‘so close to the Prophet’s house just as ‘Ali was so close to the Prophet himself).” dSJ u U jjXij u— 4 £> Sil CjS ijiStlj ill iy’j 4194. Tlte sacred month is for the sacred month, and for the prohibited things, there is the Law of equality (Qisds). Then whoever transgresses against you, you transgress likewise against him. And fear Allah, and know that Allah is with Al-Muttaqm.} Fightingduringthe SacredMonths is prohibited, except in Self-Defense Ibn ‘Abbas, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Miqsam, Ar- Rabl’ bin Anas and ‘Ata said, “Allah’s Messenger sg went for ‘Umrah on the sixth year of Hijrah. Then, the idolators prevented him from entering the Sacred House (the Ka’bah in Makkah) along with the Muslims who came with him. This incident occurred during the sacred month of Dhul-Qa’dah. The idolators agreed to allow them to enter the House the next year. Hence, the Prophet entered the House the following year, along with the Muslims who accompanied him, and Allah permitted him to avenge the idolators’ treatment of him, when He said: m Fath Al-Bari 8 :32

/Ji jfoi jffo \$The sacred month is for the sacred month, and for the prohibited things, there is the Law ofequality (Qisas).^ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “Allah’s Messenger jg would not engage in warfare during the Sacred Month unless he was first attacked, then he would march forth. He would otherwise remain idle until the end of the Sacred Months.” This Hadith has an authentic chain of narrators.¹² Hence, when the Prophet jg was told that TJthman was killed (in Makkah) when he was camped at the area of Al- Hudaybiyyah, after he had sent Uthman as his emissary to the polytheists, he accepted the pledge from his Companions under the tree to fight the polytheists. They were one thousand and four hundred then. When the Prophet jg was informed that TJthman was not killed, he abandoned the fight and reverted to peace. When the Prophet jgg finished fighting with (the tribes of) Hawazin during the battle of Hunayn and Hawazin took refuge in (the city of) At-Ta’if, he laid siege to that city. Then, the (sacred) month of Dhul-Qa’dah started, while At-Ta’if was still under siege. The siege went on for the rest of the forty days (rather, from the day the battle of Hunayn started until the Prophet ^ went back to Al-Madinah from Al-Ji’ranah, were forty days), as reported in the Two Sahihs and narrated by Anas. When the Companions suffered mounting casualties (during the siege), the Prophet sg ended the siege before conquering At-Ta’if. He then went back to Makkah, performed Vmrah from Al-Ji’ranah, where he divided the war booty of Hunayn. This Vmrah occurred during Dhul-Qa’dah of the eighth year ofAl-Hijrah}^ Allah’s statement: u Zs’xjS 4 ...whoever transgresses

against you, you transgress likewise 111 At-Jabari 3 -.575-577 and 579. Ahmad 3:345. 131 Fath Al-Bari 3 :701 and MusUm 2 :916.

against hint.} ordains justice even with the polytheists. Allah also said in another Ayah: *ti I^Ui u>j?* 4And *i/ 1/om* punish, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted.} (16:126) Allah's statement: *ija' 'ijtlclj iAnd*fear Allah, and know that Allah is *luith Al-Muttaqm* (the pious)} (2:194) commands that Allah be obeyed and feared out of Taqwa. The Ayah informs us that Allah is with those who have Taqwa by His aid and support in this life and the Hereafter. *il95*. And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction, and do good. Truly, *Alldlt* loves *Al-Mulisimn* (those who do good).} TheCommand to spend in the Cause ofAllah *Al-Bukhari* recorded that *Hudhayfah* said: *4 J^r J! ji' ^ ^*And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction .} "It was revealed about spending. ",1> *Ibn Abu Hatim* reported him saying similarly. He then commented, "Similar is reported from *Ibn 'Abbas*, *Mujahid*, *Ikrimah*, *Said bin Jubayr*, 'Ata', *Ad-Dahhak*, *Al-Hasan*, *Qatadah*, *As-Suddi* and *Muqatil bin Hayyan*." *Aslam Abu Imran* said, "A man from among the Ansar broke enemy (Byzantine) lines in Constantinople (Istanbul). *Abu Ayyub Al-Ansari* was with us then. So some people said, 'He is throwing himself to destruction.' *Abu Ayyub* said. We know (•I *Fath Al-Bari* 8 :33 .

537Surah 2. *Al-Baqarah* (175 - 200) (Part-2 this Ayah (2:195) better, for it was revealed about us, the Companions of Allah's Messenger *sg* who participated in Jihad with him and aided and supported him. When Islam became strong, we, the Ansar, met and said to each other, 'Allah has honored us by being the Companions of His Prophet *tg* and in supporting him until Islam became victorious and its following increased. We had before ignored the needs of our families, estates and children. Warfare has ceased, so let us go back to our families and children and attend to them.' So this Ayah was revealed about us: *4 Aty' J! [y^ Vi 4 4 4*.And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction the destruction refers to staying with our families and estates and abandoning Jihad'." This was recorded by *Abu Dawud*, *At- Tirmidhi*, *An-Nasal*, 'Abd bin Humayd in his Tafsir, *Ibn Abu Hatim*, *Ibn Jarir*, *Ibn Marduyah*, *Al-Hafiz Abu Yala* in his Musnad, *Ibn Hibban* and *Al-Hakim*. * *At-Tirmidhi* said; "Hasan, Sahih, Gharib '*21 *Al-Hakim* said, "It meets the criteria of the Two Shaykhs (*Al-Bukhari* and *Muslim*) but they did not record it." *Abu Dawud's* version mentions that *Aslam Abu Imran* said, "We were at (the siege of) Constantinople. Then, *TJqbah bin 'Amr* was leading the Egyptian forces, while the Syrian forces were led by *Fadalah bin TJbayd*. Later on, a huge column of Roman (Byzantine) soldiers departed the city, and we stood in lines against them. A Muslim man raided the Roman lines until he broke through them and came back to us. The people shouted, 'All praise is due to Allah! He is sending himself to certain demise.' *Abu Ayyub* said, 'O people! You explain this Ayah the wrong way. It was revealed about us, the Ansar when Allah gave victory to His religion and its following increased. We said to each other, It would be better for us now if we return to our estates and attend to them.' Then *m Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi* 8:311, *An-Nasal* in *Al-Kubra* 6:299, *Ibn Abi Hatim* 1:424, *At-Tabari* 3:590, *Ibn Hibban* 7:105, and *Al-Hakim* ' That is, almost the level of Sahih.

Allah revealed this Ayah (2:195)'."111 *Abu Bakr bin 'Aiyash* reported that *Abu Ishaq As-Subai'y* related that a man said to *Al-Bara' bin 'Azib*, "If I raided the enemy lines alone and they kill me, would I be throwing myself to certain demise?" He said, "No. Allah said to His Messenger <_i)S 'J <i' Jju* 4

{Then fight (O Muhammad jg) in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) except for yourself. (4:84) That Ayah (2:195) is about (refraining from) spending.” Ibn Marduwyah reported this Hadlth, as well as Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak who said; "It meets the criteria of the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) but they did not record it.” Ath-Thawri and Qays bin Ar-Rabi‘ related it from Al-Bara’. but added: {You are not tasked Qield responsible) except for yourself (4:84) “Destruction refers to the man who sins and refrains from repenting, thus throwing himself to destruction.” Ibn ‘Abbas said: j! &A A I&& {And spend in the cause of Allah and do not throw yourselves into destruction£ “This is not about fighting. But about refraining from spending for the sake of Allah, in which case, one will be throwing his self into destruction.” The Ayah (2:195) includes the order to spend in Allah’s cause, in the various areas and ways that involve obedience and drawing closer to Allah. It especially applies to spending in fighting the enemies and on what strengthens the Muslims against the enemy. Allah states that those who refrain from spending in this regard will face utter and certain demise and destruction, meaning those who acquire this habit. Allah Abu Dawud 3:27.

539 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2 commands that one should acquire Ihsan (excellence in the religion), as it is the highest part of the acts of obedience. Allah said: 44 if k iatid do good. Truly, Allah loves Al-Muhsinin (those who do good).) % £ £& \ja % -faj \$ % %% gii i \fo\j) ‘jtj jf >4? J? ‘i-fi; o’ Jif 1^4; J) ‘fok *H #*r-> gti ^ jS; jf. ipii 3* 6^ ji ‘£5 ff» jl iii (jijlj ijii lilij jtj^ 4jll’ > - 4296. And complete Hajj and ‘Umrah for Allah. But if you are prevented, then sacrifice a Hady that you can afford, and do not shave your heads until the Hady reaches the place of sacrifice. And whosoever of you is ill or has an ailment on his scalp (necessitating shaving), he must pay a Fidyah (ransom) of either fasting or giving Sadaqah or a sacrifice. Then if you are in safety and whosoever performs the ‘Umrah (in the months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj, he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford, but if he cannot (afford it), he should fast for three days during Hajj and seven days after his return, making ten days in all. This is for him whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al-Haram (i.e., non-resident of Makkah). And fear Allah much and know tlmt Allah is severe in punishment.) The Command to complete Hajj and ‘Umrah After Allah mentioned the rulings for fasting and Jihad, he explained the rituals by commanding the Muslims to complete Hajj and ‘Umrah, meaning, to finish the rituals of Hajj and ‘Umrah after one starts them. This is why Allah said afterwards: iBut if you are prevented)

meaning, if your way to the House is obstructed, and you are prevented from finishing it. This is why the scholars agree that starting the acts of Hajj and ‘Umrah requires one to finish them. As for Makhul, he said, “Complete, means to start them from the Miqat (areas the Prophet jg designated to assume Ihram from).” *11 ‘Abdur-Razzaq said that Az-Zuhri said: “We were told that TJmar commented on: gas 4 And complete Hajj and ‘Umrah for Allah.” {“Complete Hajj and ‘Umrah means performing each of them separately, and to perform ‘Umrah outside of the months of Hajj, for Allah the Exalted says: 4 The Hajj (pilgrimage) is (in) the well-known (lunar year) months.”} m As-Suddi said, <A P’J g 4 And complete Hajj and ‘Umrah for Allah.”} means, “Maintain the performance of Hajj and ‘Umrah.” *31 Ibn ‘Abbas was reported to have said, “Hajj is ‘Arafat, while ‘Umrah is Tawaf.” 14 Al-A‘mash related that Ibrahim said that ‘Alqamah commented on Allah’s statement: i‘AZ& &j} 4 And complete Hajj and ‘Umrah for Allah.” {“Abdullah (Ibn Mas‘ud) recited it this way: ‘Complete Hajj and ‘Umrah to the House, so that one does not exceed the area of the House during the ‘Umrah.’” Ibrahim then said, “I mentioned this statement to Said bin Jubayr and he said; Ibn ‘Abbas also said that.” 151 Sufyan

reported that Ibrahim said 111 Ibn Abi HStim 1 :437. 121 Ibid. 131 At-Tabari4:12. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :439. At-Tabari4:7.

that 'Alqamah said (regarding the Ayah 2:196), "Perform the Hajj and 'Umrah to the House." ' Ath-Thawri reported that Ibrahim read (the Ayah), "Perform the Hajj and 'Umrah to the House." If One is prevented while in Route, He slaughters the Sacrifice, shaves his Head and ends Ihram Allah's statement: iBut if you are prevented, sacrifice a Hady (animals for sacrifice) such as you can afford,} was revealed in the sixth year of Hijrah, the year of the treaty of Al-Hudaybiyyah when the polytheists prevented Allah's Messenger sg from reaching the House. Allaih revealed Surat Al-Fath (chapter 48 in the Qur'an) then, and allowed the Muslims to slaughter any Hady (animals for sacrifice) they had. They had seventy camels with them for that purpose. They were also permitted to shave their heads and end their Ihram. When the Prophet jg commanded them to shave their heads and end the state of Ihram, they did not obey him, as they were awaiting that order to be abrogated. When they saw that the Prophet jg went out after shaving his head, they imitated him. Some of them did not shave, but only shortened their hair. This is why

the Prophet jg said: «i)l "May Allah award His mercy to those who shaved They said, "What about those who shortened the hair?" He said in the third time, "And to those who shortened. [2) Every seven among them shared one camel for their sacrifice. They were one thousand and four hundred Companions and were camping in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah, outside the Sacred Area. It was also reported that they were within the boundaries of the Sacred Area. Allah knows best. Being prevented from the House (Hast) includes more than just being sick, fearing an enemy or getting lost on the way to 111 Ibid. 121 Muslim 2:946.

Makkah. Imam Ahmad reported that Al-Hajjaj bin 'Amr Al- Ansari said that he heard Allah's Messenger sg saying: ^ J*-& gj* 'j~Ay "Whoever suffered a broken bone or a limb, will have ended his Ihrdm and has to perform Hajj again. He said, "I mentioned that to Ibn 'Abbas and Abu Hurayrah and they both said, 'He (Al-Hajjaj) has said the truth'."111 This Hadith is also reported in the Four Collections . 121 In the version of Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah, the Prophet jg said, "Whoever limped, had a broken bone or became ill..."131 Ibn Abu Hatim also recorded it and said, "It was reported that Ibn MasUd, Ibn Az-Zubayr, 'Alqamah, Said bin Musayyib, 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr, Mujahid, An-Nakhal, 'Ata' and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that being prevented {Hast) entails an enemy, an illness or a fracture."141 Ath-Thawri also said, "Being prevented entails everything that harms the person."151 It is reported in the Two Sahihs that 'A'ishah said that Allah's Messenger jg went to Duba'ah bint Az-Zubayr bin 'Abdul-Muttalib who said, "O Messenger of Allah! I intend to perform Hajj but I am ill." He said, "Perform Hajj and make the condition: 'My place is where You prevent (or halt) me.'"161 Muslim recorded similarly from Ibn 'Abbas . 171 So saying such a condition for Hajj is allowed is based on this Hadith. Allah's statement: 4 . . .sacrifice a Hady such as you can afford} includes a sheep also, as Imam Malik reported that 'Ali bin Abu Talib used to say . 181 Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Hady includes eight types of animals: camels, cows, goats and sheep."191 Ahmad 3:450. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :8, and An-Nasa'i 5 :198 Abu Dawud 2 :434, and Ibn Majah 2 :1028 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :444-445 151 Ibid. 161 FathAl-Bari 9 :34 1?1 Muslim 2:868. Al-Muwatta ' 1 :385. 191 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :450

543 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) ‘Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said about what Allah said: „ sacrifice a Hady such as you can afford “As much as one could afford.”* 11 Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “If one can afford it, then camels, otherwise cows, or sheep.”*2 * Hisham bin Urwah quoted his father: v, 4^ Si Gp 4...sacrifice a Hady (animal, i.e., a sheep, a cow, or a camel) such as you can afford} ‘Depending on the price.’*3 The proof that sacrificing only a sheep is allowed in the case of being prevented from continuing the rites, is that Allah has required sacrificing whatever is available as a Hady, and the Hady is any type of cattle; be it camels, cows or sheep. This is the opinion of Ibn ‘Abbas the cousin of Allah’s Messenger gg and the scholar of Tafsir. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that ‘A’ishah, the Mother of the believers, said, “The Prophet gg once offered some sheep as Hady.”*41 Allah’s statement: i’U \j£ 4...and do not shave your heads until the Hady reaches the place of sacrifice. is a continuation of His statement: 4.A */•*\$> ji’ 4 And complete, the Hajj and ‘Umrah for Allah. and is not dependent upon: 4t0su’j&t fad 4 But if you are prevented, then sacrifice a Hady *’* Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :451 At-Tabari 4 :30 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :452 * Path Al-Bari 3 :639 and Muslim 2 :958

544 Tafsir Ibn Katlir as Ibn Jarir has erroneously claimed. When the Prophet^Jg and his Companions were prevented from entering the Sacred House during the Al-Hudaybiyyah year by the polytheists from Quraysh, they shaved their heads and sacrificed their Hady outside the Haram (Sacred) area. In normal circumstances, and when one can safely reach the House, he is not allowed to shave his head until: 4 ...and do not shave your heads until the Hady reaches the place of sacrifice.4 and then he ends the rituals of Hajj or ‘Umrah, or both if he had assumed Ihram for both. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Hafsa said, “O Allah’s Messenger! What is wrong with the people, they have finished their Ihram for ‘Umrah but you have not?” The Prophet jg said, «/ matted my hair and I have garlanded my Hady (animals for sacrifice), so I will not finish my Ihram till I offer the sacrifice .» [11 Whoever shaved his Head during Ihram, will have to pay the Fidyah Allah said: 4 And whosoever of you is ill or has an ailment on his scalp (necessitating shaving), he must pay a Fidyah> Al-Bukhari reported that ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Asbahani said that he heard ‘Abdullah bin Ma’qil saying that he sat with Ka*b bin TJrah in the mosque of Kufah (in Iraq). He then asked him about the Fidyah of the fasting. Ka*b said, “This was revealed concerning my case especially, but it is also for you in general. I was carried to Allah’s Messenger jg and the lice were falling in great numbers on my face. The Prophet jg said: m Fath Al-Bari 3 :493 and Muslim 2 :902

545 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) N : cJJ i IJla JAj jl^JI jf Ui «/ newer thought that your ailment (or struggle) had reached to such an extent as I see. Can you afford a sheep (for sacrifice)?’ I replied in the negative .» He then said: \ j\ fd ISj <• > * > # "Fast ybr //iree days or /eed si* poor persons, each with half a Sd’ of food (1 Sa’ = 3 kilograms approx.) and shave your head .» So this is a general judgement derived from a specific case. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ka*b bin TJrah said, “Allah’s Messenger sfe came by while I was igniting the fire under a pot and while the lice were falling down my head or my eyelids. He said: «Do these lice in your head bother you?» I said, "Yes.’ He said: s<SL_j iJLLjl j\ nilAU «Shave it, then fast three days, or feed six poor people, or sacrifice an animal .» Ayyub (one of the narrators of the Hadith) commented, “I do not know which alternative was stated first.”*12 * The wording of the Qur’an begins with the easiest then the more difficult options: “Pay a Fidyah of fasting (three days), feeding (six poor persons) or sacrificing (an animal).” Meanwhile, the Prophet^ advised Ka*b with the more rewarding option first, that is, sacrificing a sheep,

then feeding six poor persons, then fasting three days. Each Text is suitable in its place and context, all the thanks and praises are due to Allah. Tamattu during Hajj Allah said: 111 FathAl-B&ri 8:34. * Ahmad 4:241

546 Tafstr Ibn Kathir »Z& G gJ ji £%p £Hr# iThen if you are in safety and whosoever performs the 'Umrah (in the months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj, he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford,} That is, when you are able to complete the rites, so whoever among you connects his 'Umrah with Hajj having the same Ihram for both, or, first assuming Ihram for 'Umrah, and then assuming Ihram for Hajjwhen finished the 'Umrah, this is the more specific type of Tamattu' which is well-known among the discussion of the scholars whereas in general there are two types of Tamattu ', as the authentic Hadiths prove, since among the narrators are those who said, "Allah's Messenger jg performed Tamattu', and others who said, "Qa/in" but there is no difference between them over the Hady. So Allah said, G gfJ jl p£ ty} iThen ifyou are in safety and whosoever performs the 'Umrah (in the months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj (i.e., Hajj At-Tamattu' and Al-Qiran), he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford,} means let him sacrifice whatever Hady is available to him, the least of which is a sheep. One is also allowed to sacrifice a cow because the Prophet jg slaughtered cows on behalf of his wives. Al-Awza! reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger jg slaughtered cows on behalf of his wives when they were performing Tamattu') 1 ^ This was reported by Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah. This last Hadlth proves that Tamattu' is legislated. It is reported in the Two Sahdhs that Imran bin Husayn said, "We performed Hajj At-Tamattu' in the lifetime of Allah's Messenger Sg and then the Qur'an was revealed (regarding Hajj At- Tamattu). Nothing was revealed to forbid it, nor did he (the Prophet forbid it until he died. And somebody said what he wished (regarding Hajj At-Tamattu) according to his own opinion. "I21 Al-Bukhari said that Imran was talking about Abu Dfiwud 2:362. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 8 : 34 and Muslim 2 :900

547Surah 2. Al-Bagaralt (175 - 200) (Part-2) 'Umar. It is reported in an authentic narration that 'Umar used to discourage the people from performing Tamattu'. He used to say, "If we refer to Allah's Book, we should complete it," meaning: iU® * a& Ji p& 4 .. .whosoever performs the 'Urnralt (in tlte months of Hajj), before (performing) the Hajj, he must slaughter a Hady such as he can afford,\$ However 'Umar did not say that Tamattu' is unlawful. He only prevented them so that the people would increase their trips to the House for Hajj (during the months of Hajj) and Vmrah (throughout the year), as he himself has stated. Whoever performs Tamattu should fastTen Days ifHe does not have aHady Allah said: 4 '(u. Jij; iji 'p 4 4.. but ifhe cannot (afford it), he should fast three days during the Hajj and seven days after his return (to his home), making ten days in all> This Ayah means: "Those who do not find a Hady, let them fast three days during the Hajj season." Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "If one does not have a Hady, he should fast three days during Hajj, before 'Arafah day. If the day of 'Arafah was the third day, then his fast is complete. He should also fast seven days when he gets back home."1 ' 1 Abu Ishaq reported from Wabarrah from Ibn 'Umar who said, "One fasts one day before the day of Tarwiyah, the day of Tarwiyah (eighth day of Dhul-Hijjah) and then 'Arafah day (the ninth day of the month of Dhul-Hijjah). ""*21 The same state ment was reported by Ja'far bin Muhammad from his father from 'Ali.13 If one did not fast these three days or at least some of them before 'Id day (the tenth day of Dhul-Hijjah), he is allowed to At-Tabari 4 :97 121 At-Tabari 4:95. At-Tabari 4 :94

fast during the Tashriq days (11-12-13th day of Dhul-Hijjah). 'A'ishah and Ibn 'Umar said, "Fasting the days of Tashriq was only allowed for those who did not find the Hady" as Al- Bukhari has reported. Sufyan related that Ja'far bin Muhammad narrated that his father said that 'Ali said, "Whoever did not fast the three days during the Hajj, should fast them during the days of Tashriq." This is also the position taken by TBayd bin TMayr Al-Laythi, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al- Basri and TJrwah bin Az- Zubayr, referring to the general meaning of Allah's statement: 4[^] 4\$ 1 . . .fast three days during the Hajj . As for what Muslim reported that Qutaybah Al-Hudhali said that Allah's Messenger said: p <il hj AS\ id Jijlls I ;d» ' * * " - ' >The days of Tashriq are days of eating and drinking and remembering Allah the Exalted .»*21 This narration is general in meaning while what 'A'ishah and Ibn 'Umar narrated is specific. Allah said: .and seven days after his return .} There are two opinions regarding the meaning of this Ayah. First, it means "when you return to the camping areas'. The second, upon going back home. 'Abdur-Razzaq reported that Salim narrated that he heard Ibn 'Umar saying: "i...but if he cannot (afford it), he should fast three days during the Hajj and seven days after his return,} means when he goes back to his family. ",31 The same opinion was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, 'Ata', 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Imam Az-Zuhri and Ar- At-Tabari 4 :98-99 121 Muslim 2:800. ,3 I Tafsir 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :76.

Rabl' bin Anas.' Al-Bukhari reported that Salim bin 'Abdullah narrated that Ibn 'Umar said, "During the Farewell Hajj of Allah's Messenger Sg, he performed Tamattu' with 'Umrah and Hajj. He drove a Hady along with him from Dhul-Hulayfah. Allah's Messenger jg started by assuming Ihram for 'Umrah, and then for Hajj. And the people, too, performed the 'Umrah and Hajj along with the Prophet sg. Some of them brought the Hady and drove it along with them, while the others did not. So, when the Prophet jg arrived at Makkah, he said to the people: Isj '**** Cr?*- J*- Jt V JfcJ (*J jSw j! lij IjJA JL>o jU .utf ^Whoever among you has driven the Hady, shoidd not finish his Ihram till he completes his Hajj. And whoever among you has not (driven) the Hady with him, he should perform Tawaf of the Ka'bah and between As-Safd and Al-Marwah. Then, he should shave or cut his hair short and finish his Ihram, and should later assume Ihram far Hajj; [but he must offer a Hady (sacrifice)]. And if anyone cannot afford a Hady, he should fast far three days during the Hajj and seven days when he returns home.» He then mentioned the rest of the Hadith, which is reported in the Two SahXhsP1 Allah said: it# Xju- 4 ...making ten days in all> to emphasize the ruling we mentioned above. This method is common in the Arabic language, for they would say, 'I have seen with my eyes, heard with my ears and written with my hand,' to emphasize such facts. Similarly, Allah said: Ibn Abi Hatim 2:498. ' Fath Al-Bari 3 : 630 and Muslim 2 :901

550 Tafsir Ibit Kaihir 4...nor a bird thatflies with its two wings» (6:38) and: 4...nor did you write any book (whatsoever) with your right hand) (29:48) and: iAnd We appointed for Musa thirty nights and added (to the period) ten (more), and he completed the term, appointed by his Lord, offorty nights.) (7:142) It was also said that the meaning of "ten days in all" emphasizes the order to fast for ten days, not less than that. The Residents ofMakkah do not perform Tamattu Allah said: 4^/^- jW iThis is for him whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al- Hararn (i.e., mn-resident ofMakkah).) Tltis Ayah concerns the residents of the area of the Haram, for they do not perform Tamattu 'Abdur-Razzaq reported that Tawus said, "Tamattu is for the people, those whose families are not residing in the Haram area (Makkah), not for the residents ofMakkah. Hence Allah's Statement: i/jti iThis is for him

whose family is not present at Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (i.e., non-resident of Makkah) ‘Abdur-Razzaq then said, “I was also told that Ibn ‘Abbas said similar to TawQs.” Allah said: i . .and fear Allah) meaning, in what He has commanded you and what He prohibited for you. He then said: ji jLj£ \$ 3 \pi\ i...and know that Allah is severe in punishment) m At-Tabari 4:111.

552 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) J mm n aiap < . '/< '<z» \$ -4Vt4jk >K3fi*is!A^Ji0 5@£SiW Vi for those who defy His command and commit what He has prohibited. o*~» — j~*-' juJ'y * gi1 dfj g»J' 4 J'i-t vj - - **^3 jS> <s>> < ,<S* / .5 SS^i (j-j) \jL*5UJ .>41tiLi) Jr? ~ *r . [V tr 4&) Uju jAj* ^ \jX*..a\ }fy J*- ^£>Jj 1)^5j->3 ^v^dVi Jti pjftj 4297. 77w Hajj (pilgrimage) is (in) the well-known months. So whosoever intends to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Dirdm), then he should not have sex- ual relations (with his wife), nor commit sin, nor dispute unjustly during the Hajj. And whatever good you do, Allah brows it. And take provisions for the journey, but the best provision is At- Taqwa (piety, righteousness). So fear Me, O men of understanding!} When does Ihram for Hajj start Allah said: ii \$The Hajj is (in) the well-known months.} This Ayah indicates that Ihram for Hajj only occurs during the months of Hajj. This was reported from Ibn ‘Abbas , Jabir, ‘Ata’, Tawus and Mujahid. The proof for this is Allah’s HI At-Tabari 4 :1 15.

552 Tflfebr Ibn Kathir statement that Hajj occurs during known, specific months, which indicates that Hajj is not allowed before that, just as the prayer has a fixed time (before which one's prayer is not accepted). Ash-Shafil recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “No person should assume Ihram for Hajj before the months of the Hajj, for Allah said: \$The Hajj is (in) the well-knmon months Ibn Khuzaymah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “No Ihram for Hajj should be assumed, except during the months of Hajj for among the Sunnah of Hajj is that one assume Ihram for it during the Hajj months.” This is an authentic narration and the Companion’s statement that such and such is among the Sunnah is considered as a Hadith of the Prophet jg, according to the majority of the scholars. This is especially the case when it is Ibn ‘Abbas who issued this statement, as he is the Tarjuman (translator, interpreter, explainer) of the Qur’an. There is a Hadith about this subject too. Ibn Marduwyah related that Jabir narrated that the Prophet jg said: Jt V) fj>y oi aNo one should assume Ihram for Hajj, but during the months ofHajj.*™ The chain of narrators for this Hadith is reasonable. Ash- Shafit and Al-Bayhaqi recorded this Hadith from Ibn Jurayj who related that Abu Az-Zubayr said that he heard Jabir bin ‘Abdullah being asked, “Does one assume Ihram for Hajj before the months of the Hajp” He said, “No.”*41 This narration is more reliable than the narration that we mentioned from the Prophet jg. In short, this statement is the opinion of the Companion, supported by Ibn ‘Abbas’ statement that it is a part of the Sunnah not to assume Ihram for Hajj before the Al-Umm 2 :132 . Ibn Khuzaymah 4 :162 . Al-MusannafIbnAbi Shaybah, and Tafsir ‘Abdur-Razzaq. ^ Al-Umm 2 :132 , and Al-Bayhaqi 4 :343 .

months of the Hajj. Allah knows best. The Months ofHajj Allah said: 4...the well-known months.} Al-Bukhari said that Ibn ‘Umar said that these are Shawwal, Dhul-Qa‘dah and the first ten days of Dhul-Hijjah. This narration for which Al-Bukhari did not mention the chain of narrators, was collected by a continuous chain of narrators that Ibn Jarir rendered authentic, leading to Ibn Umar, who said: 4The Hajj (pilgrimage) is (in) the well-known (lunar year) months.} “which are Shawwal, Dhul-Qa‘dah and the (first) ten days of Dhul-Hijjah.”121 Its chain is SahOi. Al-Hakim also recorded it in his Mustadrak, and he said, “It meets the criteria of the Two Shaykhs.”13 ’ This statement is also reported from Umar,

‘Ali, Ibn Mas‘ud, ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr, Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ata’, Tawus, Mujahid, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Imam Ash-Sha‘bi, Al-Hasan, Ibn Sirin, Makhul, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim, Ar-Rab‘ bin Anas and Muqatil bin Hayyan. This opinion was preferred by Ibn Jarir who said, “It is a common practice to call two months and a part of the third month as ‘months’. This is similar to the Arab’s saying, ‘I visited such and such person this year or this day.’ He only visited him during a part of the year and a part of the day. Allah said: 4But whosoever hastens to leave in two days, there is no sin on him.} 111 Fath Al-Bari 3 :490 At-Tabari 4:116. 131 Al-Hakim 2:276. ^4 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :486-488

554 Tafsir Ibn Kathir In this case, one will only be hastening for one and a half days.” Allah then said: iSo whosoever intends (Farada) to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Ihram),} meaning that one’s assuming the Ihram requires a Hajj, for the person is required to complete the rituals of Hajj after assuming Ihram. Ibn Jarir said that Al-‘Awfi said, “The scholars agree that (Farada) ‘intends’ mentioned in the Ayah means it is a requirement and an obligation.” 111 ‘Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said: iSo whosoever intends to perform Hajj therein (by assuming Ihram), refers to those who assume Ihram for Hajj and ‘Umrah’. ‘Ata’ said, “‘Intends’, means, assumes the Ihram.” Similar statements were attributed to Ibrahim, Ad-Dahhak and others.’2 ^ Prohibition of Rafath (Sexual Intercourse) during Hajj Allah said: iHe should not have Rafath^ This Ayah means that those who assume the Ihram for Hajj or ‘Umrah are required to avoid the Rafath, meaning, sexual intercourse. Allah’s statement here is similar to His statement: iIt is made lawful for you to have Rafath (sexual relations) with your wives on the night of the fast.> (2:187) Whatever might lead to sexual intercourse, such as embracing, kissing and talking to women about similar 111 At-Tabari 4:120-121. At-Tabari 4:123.

555 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) subjects, is not allowed. Ibn Jarir reported that Nafi‘ narrated that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar said, “Rafath means sexual intercourse or mentioning this subject with the tongue, by either men or women.”111 ‘Ata’ bin Abu Rabah said that Rafath means sexual intercourse and foul speech.121 This is also the opinion of ‘Amr bin Dinar. ‘Ata’ also said that they used to even prevent talking (or hinting) about this subject.131 Tawtis said that Rafath includes one’s saying, “When I end the Ihram I will have sex with you.” This is also the same explanation offered by Abu Al-‘Aliyah regarding Rafath. ‘Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Rafath means having sex with the wife, kissing, fondling and saying foul words to her, and similar acts.” 151 Ibn ‘Abbas and Ibn ‘Umar said that Rafath means to have sex with women. 161 This is also the opinion of Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Abu Al-‘Aliyah who narrated it from ‘Ata’ and Makhul, ‘Ata Al-Khurasani, ‘Ata’ bin Yasar, ‘Atiyah, Ibrahim, Ar-Rabi‘, Az-Zuhri, As-Suddi, Malik bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, ‘Abdul-Karim bin Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak, and others. The Prohibition of Fusuq during Hajj Allah said: 4...nor commit sin£ Miqsam and several other scholars related that Ibn ‘Abbas said, "It is disobedience." This is also the opinion of ‘Ata,’ Mujahid, Tawus, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka‘b, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Az-Zuhri, Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas, ‘Ata’ bin Yasar, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani and Muqatil bin Hayyan.171 Ibn Wahb reported that Nafi‘ narrated that ‘Abdullah bin m At-Tabari 4:126. 121 At-Tabari 4:127. At-Tabari 4:128. Ibid. 151 Al-Tabari 4:129. 161 Ibid. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :497-500

“Umar said, “Fusuq [or sin mentioned in the Ayah (2:197)] refers to committing what Allah has forbidden in the Sacred Area.”111 Several others said that Fusuq means cursing others, they based this

on the authentic Hadith: ,4^Jl «Cursing the Muslim is Fusuq, while fighting him is Kufr . ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said Fusuq here means slaughtering animals for the idols, as Allah said: 4'a jyJ J>1 lili jfy 4...or impious (Fisq) meat (of an animal) which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah> (6:145) Ad-Dahhak said that Fusuq is insulting one another with bad nicknames. Those who said that the Fusuq means all types of disobedience are correct. Allah has also prohibited committing injustice during the months of Hajj in specific, although injustice is prohibited throughout the year. This is why Allah said: 4...of them four are sacred. That is the right religion, so wrong not yourselves therein.} (9:36) Allah said about the Sacred Area: 4fi) Vri v-5 .and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong, him We shall cause to taste from a painful torment.} (22:25) It is recorded in the Two Sahihis that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah’s Messenger jg said: «<•(*jji gjj- \±j 'ji ^ii IJU £> “Whoever performed Hajj to this (Sacred) House and did not commit Rafath or Fusuq, will return sinless, just as the day his m Ibn Abi Hatim 2:497. 121 Fath Al-Bdri 1 :135.

mother gave birth to him The Prohibition of arguing during Hajj Allah said: 4 fo-t 4nor should there be Jiddl during Hajj} meaning, disputes and arguments. Ibn Jarir related that ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud said that what Allah said: 4 . -nor dispute unjustly during the Hajj.} means to argue with your companion (or fellow) until you make him angry. This is similar to the opinion that Miqdam and Ad-Dahhak related to Ibn ‘Abbas.¹²¹ This is also the same meaning reported from Abu Al-‘Aliyah, ‘Ata’, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Jabir bin Zayd, ‘Ata’ Al- Khurasani, Makh’al, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, ‘Amr bin Dinar, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi’ bin Anas, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, ‘Ata bin Yasar, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri.*³¹ The Encouragement for Righteous Deeds and to bring Provisions for Hajj Allah said: aILju jji \Zj} 4And whatever good you do, Allah blows it.} After Allah prohibited evil in deed and tongue, He encouraged righteous, good deeds, stating that He is knowledgeable of the good that they do, and He will reward them with the best awards on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next: 0 ££ 4And take provisions (with you) for the journey, but the best Fath Al-Bari 4 :25 and Muslim 2 : 983 . At-Tabari 4:141. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :503-505 :

provision is At-Taqlia (piety, righteousness) .)» Al-Bukhari and Abu Dawud reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The people of Yemen used to go to Hajj without taking enough supplies with them. They used to say, *We are those who have Tawakkul (reliance on Allah).’ Allah revealed this Ayah: iAnd take provisions (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is At-Taqlia (piety, righteousness).^ Ibn Jarir and Ibn Marduyah narrated that Ibn ‘Umar said, “When people assumed Ihram, they would throw away whatever provisions they had and would acquire other types of provisions. Allah revealed: il&l' 0> iAnd take a provisions (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is At-Taqlw (piety, righteousness).} Allah forbade them from this practice and required them to take flour and Sawiq (a type of food usually eaten with dates) with them.”¹²¹ The Provisions of the Hereafter Allah said: &% djfr .but the best provision is At-Taqlw (piety, righteousness).} When Allah required mankind to supply themselves with what sustains them for the journeys of this life, He directed them to the necessary provisions for the Hereafter: Taqlw. Allah said in another Ayah T tSjB' o-Uj .and as an adornment; and the raiment of Taqlw, that is better.} (7:26) Allah mentioned the material covering and then He Fath Al-Bari 3 :449 , Abu Dawud 2 :309. At-Jabari 4:156.

559 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) mentioned the spiritual covering, which includes humbleness, obedience and Taqwa. He also stated that the latter provision is better and more beneficial than the former. {So fear Me, O men of understanding!} meaning: "Fear My torment, punishment, and affliction for those who defy Me and do not adhere to My commands, O people of reason and understanding." {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} Then when you leave 'Arafat, remember Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash'ar-il-Haram. And remember Him (by invoking Allah for all good) as He has guided you, and verily you were before, of those who were astray}. Commercial Transactions during Hajj Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Ukaz, Mijannah and Dhul-Majaz were trading posts during the time of Jahiliyyah. During that era, they did not like the idea of conducting business transactions during the Hajj season. Later, this Ayah was revealed: {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord.} during the Hajj season." 111 Abu Dawud and others recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They used to avoid conducting business transactions during the Hajj season, saying that these are the days of Dhikr. Allah revealed: {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} This is also the explanation of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Mansur bin Al-Mu'tamir, Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ar-Rab' bin Anas and others. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Umaymah said that when Ibn Umar was asked about conducting trade during the Hajj, he recited the Ayah: {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} This Hadith is related to Ibn 'Umar with a strong chain of narrators. This Hadith is also related to the Prophet ﷺ, as Ahmad reported that Abu Umamah At-Taymi said, "I asked Ibn Umar, 'We buy (and sell during the Hajj), so do we still have a valid Hajj?' He said, 'Do you not perform Tawaf around the House, stand at 'Arafat, throw the pebbles and shave your heads?' I said, 'Yes.' Ibn Umar said, 'A man came to the Prophet ﷺ and asked him about what you asked me, and the Prophet did not answer him until Jibril came down with this Ayah: {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} The Prophet ﷺ summoned the man and said: "You are pilgrims." Ibn Jarir narrated that Abu Salih said to Umar, "O Leader of the faithful! Did you conduct trade transactions during the Hajj?" He said, "Was their livelihood except during Hajj?" W Standing at 'Arafat Allah said: {There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} Abu Dawud 2:350. At-Tabari 4:165. 131 Ahmad 2:155. A*-Tabari 4:168.

561 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (175 - 200) (Part-2) {Then when you leave 'Arafat, remember Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash'ar-il-Haram} 'Arafat is the place where one stands during the Hajj and it is a pillar of the rituals of Hajj Imam Ahmad and the Sunan compilers recorded that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Ya'mar Ad-Diyli said that he heard Allah's Messenger saying: "Whoever stands at 'Arafat (thrice). Hence, those who have stood at 'Arafat before dawn will have performed (the rituals of the Hajj). The days of Mina are three, and there is no sin for those who move on after two days, or for those who stay. The time to stand on 'Arafat starts from noon on the day of 'Arafat until dawn the next day, which is the day of the Sacrifice (the tenth day of Dhul-Hijjah). The Prophet ﷺ stood at 'Arafat during the Farewell Hajj, after he had offered the Zuhr (noon) prayer, until sunset. He said, "Learn your rituals from me." 121 In this Hadith (i.e., in the previous paragraph) he said, "Whoever stood at 'Arafat before dawn, will have performed (the rituals of Hajj)." Tirmidhi bin

Mudarris bin Harithah bin Lam At-Ta'i said, "I came to Allah's Messenger ﷺ at Al-Muzdalifah when it was time to pray. I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! I came from the two mountains of Tayy and my animal became tired and I became tired. I have not left any mountain, but stood on it. Do I have a valid Hajj?' Allah's Messenger said: *liyu* —Hj Jij C* ly OjU I ^Whoever performed this prayer with us, stood with us until we moved forth, and had stood at 'Arafat before that, day or night, will have performed the Hajj and completed its rituals*." I 1 ' Ahmad 4:310, Abu Dawud 2:485, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:633, An- Nasal 5 :256 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1003 * Muslim 2 :943

This Hadith was collected by Imam Ahmad and the compilers of the Sunan, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahib. ' It was reported that the mount was called 'Arafat because, as 'Abdur- Razzaq reported that 'Ali bin Abu Talib said, "Allah sent Jibril to Prophet Ibrahim and he performed Hajj for him (to teach him its rituals). When Ibrahim reached 'Arafat he said, I have 'Araftu (I know this place).' He had come to that area before. Thereafter, it was called 'Arafat.'"2 ' Ibn Al-Mubarak said that 'Ata' said, "It was called 'Arafat because Jibril used to teach Ibrahim the rituals of Hajj. Ibrahim would say, I have 'Araftu, I have 'Araftu.' It was thereafter called 'Arafat." Similar statements were attributed to Ibn 'Abbas'3 ' , Ibn Tjmar and Abu Mijlaz.'4 ' Allah knows best. 'Arafat is also called Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram, Al-Mash'ar Al- Aqsa and Ilal, while the mount that is in the middle of 'Arafat is called Jabal Ar-Rahmah (Mount of Mercy). The Time to leave 'Arafat and Al-Muzdalifah Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "During the time of JahUyyah, the people used to stand at 'Arafat. When the sun would be on top of the mountains, just as the turban is on top of a man's head, they would move on. Allah's Messenger jg delayed moving from 'Arafat until sunset."5 ' Ibn Marduwyah related this Hadith and added, "He then stood at Al-Muzdalifah and offered the Fajr (Dawn) prayer at an early time. When the light of dawn broke, he moved on." This Hadith has a Hasan chain of narrators. The long Hadith that Jabir bin 'Abdullah narrated, which Muslim collected, stated, "The Prophet jg kept standing there (meaning at 'Arafat) until sunset, when the yeUow light had somewhat gone and the disc of the sun had disappeared. Then, the Prophet \$g made Usamah sit behind him, and in order to keep her under control, puUed the nose string of Al-Qaswa' so hard, that its head touched the saddle. He gestured with his right hand and '* Ahmad 4:261, Abu D&wud 2:486, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:633, An- Nasal 5:264, and Ibn Majah 2:1004. 'Abdur-Razzaq 5 :96 At-Jabari 4:173-174. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :519 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:517.

563 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah Cl75 - 200) (Part-2) said, "Proceed calmly people, calmly!" Whenever he happened to pass over an elevated tract of sand, he lightly loosened the nose string of his camel till she climbed up and this is how they reached Al-Muzdalifah. There, he led the Maghrib (Evening) and 'Isha' (Night) prayers with one Adhan and two Iqamah (which announces the imminent start of the acts of the prayer) and did not glorify Allah in between them (i.e., he did not perform voluntary Rak'ah). Allah's Messenger jg then laid down till dawn and offered the Fajr (Dawn) prayer with Adhan and Iqamah, when the morning light was clear. He again mounted Al-Qaswa', and when he came to Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram, he faced towards Qiblah, supplicated to Allah, glorifying Him and saying, La ilaha illalldh, and he continued standing until the daylight was very clear. He then went quickly before the sun rose. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Usamah bin Zayd was asked, "How was the Prophet's pace when he moved?" He said, "Slow, unless he found space, then he would go a little faster."2' Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram 'Abdur-Razzaq reported that Ibn 'Umar said that all of Al- Muzdalifah is Al-Mash'ar Al-Haram.13 ' It was reported that Ibn "Umar was asked about Allah's statement: i* at 4...remember

Allah (by glorifying His praises, i.e., prayers and invocations) at the Mash‘ar-il-Haram . \$ He said, “It is the Mount and the surrounding area.”*4 ‘ It was reported that Al-Mash‘ar Al-Haram is what is between the two Mounts (refer to the following Hadith), as Ibn ‘Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, Al- Hasan and Qatadah have stated.’5’ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jubayr bin Mutlm narrated that the Prophet |g said: m Muslim 2:886. 121 FathAl-Bari 3 :605 , Muslim 2 :936 ’3| Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :521 ’ At-Tabari 4:176. 151 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :521-522.

Jr Ibn Kathir " jZ Z&yfi o* *T’^> j£» «A// 0/ ‘Arafat is a place of standing, and keep away from ‘Uranah . All of Al-Muzdalifah is a place for standing, and keep away from the bottom of Muhassir. All of the areas of Makkah are a place for sacrifice, and all of the days of Tashrfq are days of sacrifice V Allah then said: \jS ilj} i And remember Him (by invoking Allah for all good) as He has guided you.’} This Ayah reminds Muslims of Allah’s bounty on them that He has directed and taught them the rituals of Hajj according to the guidance of Prophet Ibrahim Al-Khalil. This is why Allah said: i...and verily, you were, before, of those who were astray.} It was said that this Ayah refers to the condition before the guidance or the Qur’an or the Messenger all of which are correct meanings. 4199. Then depart from the place whence all the people depart and ask Allah for His forgiveness. Truly, Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most-Merciful. The Order to stand on ‘Arafat and to depart from it 4 This Ayah contains Allah’s order to those who stand at ‘Arafat to also move on to Al-Muzdalifah, so that they remember Allah at Al-Mash‘ar Al-Haram. Allah commands the Muslim to stand with the rest of the pilgrims at ‘Arafat, unlike Quraysh who (before Islam) used to remain in the sanctuary, near Al- Muzdalifah, saying that they are the people of Allah’s Town and m Ahmad 4 :82

565 Surah 2. Al-Baqarali (175 - 200) (Part-2) the servants of His House. Al-Bukhari reported that ‘A’ishah said, “Quraysh and their allies, who used to be called Al- //ums * , used to stay in Al-Muzdalifah while the rest of the Arabs would stand at ‘Arafat. When Islam came, Allah commanded His Prophet ^ to stand at ‘Arafat and then proceed from there. Hence Allah’s statement: iJ-dit 4 . . .from the place whence all the people depart. This was also said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ata’, Qatadah and As-Suddi and others.131 Ibn Jarir chose this opinion and said that there is Ijma‘ (a consensus among the scholars) for it. Imam Ahmad reported that Jubayr bin Mut‘im said, “My camel was lost and I went out in search of it on the day of ‘Arafah, and I saw the Prophet |g standing in ‘Arafat. I said to myself, *By Allah he is from the Hums. What has brought him here?’”14 ‘ This Hadith is also reported in the SahDiayn.^ Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that ‘depart’ mentioned in the Ayah refers to proceeding from Al-Muzdalifah to Mina to stone the pillars.*6 ‘ Allah knows best. Asking Allah for His Forgiveness Allah said: i...and ask Allah for His forgiveness. Truly, Allah is Oft- Forgiving , Most-Merciful .^ Allah frequently orders remembrance of Him after acts of worship are finished. Muslim reported that Allah’s Messenger M used to ask Allah for His forgiveness thrice after the prayer ’** Literally, “strictly religious”, Quraysh were called so, as they used to say, “We are the people of Allah, we do not go out of the sanctuary.” 121 FathAl-Bari 8 :35 At-Jabari 4:186-187. * Ahmad 4 :80 * Fath Al-Bari 3 :602 , and Muslim 2 :894 |6’ Fath Al-Bari 8 :35

is finished.11 ‘ It is reported in the Two SahVis that the Prophet M encouraged TasbOi (saying Subhan Allah, i.e., Glorified is Allah), Tahmui (saying Al-Hamdu Lillah, i.e., praise be to Allah) and Takbir (saying Allahu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Great) thirty-three times each (after prayer).’2’ Ibn

Marduwyah collected the Hadith that Al-Bukhari reported from Shaddad bin Aws, who stated that Allah's Messenger% said: lbj ic~>f Ml ill M cJI I : jJUl (Jjij jl jLiiliMl .O U 3- dO tj . illi; . »l li bxl-jj bjj Ulj ihjlc- 14JI>y tjji Ml ^j-ill jiW M Jzs* li i^Jjb *y^j i sill '*1>Jl J^O oUi K*yM l^jli ytj tiLJI -db Jji olii ill)^ "77ie master ofsupplication for forgiveness, is for the servant to say: 'O Allah! You are my Lord, there is no deity worthy of worship except You. You have created me and I am Your servant. I am on Your covenant, as much as I can be, and awaiting Your promise. I seek refuge witlt You from the evil that I have committed. I admit Yourfavor on me and admit my faults. So forgive me, for none except You forgives the sins.' Whoever said these words at night and died that same night will enter Paradise. Whoever said it during the day and died will enter Paradise .»'3 ' Furthermore, it is reported in the Two Sahths that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that Abu Bakr said, "O Messenger of Allah! Teach me an invocation so that I may invoke (Allah) with it in my prayer. He told me to say: J oil MJ 4-jJili 'jk Mj \ys Uit Jj : ji» j^ll jJl JJUJ tlloyy 'ji vAllahumma innt zalamtu nafsi zulman kathiran, wa la yaghfirudh-dhunuba ilia Anta faghfirli maghfiratan min 'indika, war-hamni innaka Antal-Ghafur-ur-Rahim (O Allah! I have done great injustice to myself and none except You forgives Muslim 1 :414. 121 Fath Al-Bari2 :378 and Muslim 1 :417. ' Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :100

sins, so please forgive me and be merciful to me as You are the Forgiver, the Merciful).^ There are many other Hadiths on this subject. -ffjjf iii l_jji==oS l> O' >-<-U 0? Art?* ' i ^ '-J ClIK JjIj ;> JbJji f;jdii^ &S && 4 tsr. eg QEr“ *Mt 'j--^ ^ <200. So ivhen you have accomplished your Mandsik, remember Allah as you remember your forefathers or with far more remembrance. But of mankind there are some who say: "Our Lord! Give us (Your bounties) in this world!" and for such there will be no portion in the Hereafter.} 4202 . And of than there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save usfrom the torment of the Fire!"} 4202 . For than there will be allotted a share for what they have earned. And Allah is swift at reckoning.} The Order for Remembrance of Allah and seeking Good in this Lifeand the Hereafteruponcompletingthe Rites otHajj Allah commands that He be remembered after the rituals are performed. 4ft=*X£ *%\$} 4...as you ranember yourforefathers} Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "During the time of Jdhiliyyah, people used to stand during the {Hay) season, and one of them would say, 'My father used to feed (the poor), help others (end their disputes, with his money), pay the Diyah (i.e., blood money),' and so forth. The only Dhikr that they had was that they would remember the deeds of their fathers. Allah then revealed to Muhammad jg: *** Fath Al-Bari 13 :484 and Muslim 4 :2078

mentioned. Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Some bedouins used to come to the standing area ('Arafat) and supplicate saying, 'O Allah! Make it a rainy year, a fertile year and a year of good child bearing.' They would not mention any of the affairs of the Hereafter. Thus, Allah revealed about them: 4^i Ji , \ £ ^ tjiU tij jjij jS ^*±} }But of mankind there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us (Your bounties) in this world!" and for such there will be no portion in the Hereafter. The believers who came after them used to say: 4jU! v'ic cij iOur Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save us from the torment of the Fire!"} Next, Allah revealed: iFor them there will be allotted a share for what they have earned. And Allah is swift at reckoning.} Hence, Allah praised those who ask for the affairs of both this life and the Hereafter. He said: 4S^> 4And of them there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter

that which is good, and save us from the torment of the Fire!”} The supplication mentioned and praised in the Ayah includes all good aspects of this life and seeks refuge from all types of evil. The good of this life concerns every material request of well-being, spacious dwelling, pleasing mates, sufficient provision, beneficial knowledge, good profession or deeds, comfortable means of transportation and good praise, all of which the scholars of Tafsir have mentioned regarding this subject. All of these are but a part of the good that is sought in this life.

571 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 Muslim also recorded it.' Al-Hakim reported that Said bin Jubayr said, “A man came to Ibn ‘Abbas and said, ‘I worked for some people and settled for a part of my compensation in return for their taking me to perform Hajj with them. Is this acceptable?’ Ibn ‘Abbas said, ‘You are among those whom Allah described: 4 r- iFor them there will be allotted a share for what they have earned. And Allah is swift at reckoning Al-Hakim then commented; "This Hadith is authentic according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) although they did not record it." jaisS rT ^1 i3*J i jA-jlj 4&fjJ«Lj)jj 0 i\4J 0 jJ*V>gOyii\ o*j pt ^*4 v?j> <4 J**» -j iif <4i 'i? (Jlj \$r^ 4203. And remember Allah during the Appointed Days. But whosoever hastens to leave in two days, there is no sin on him and whosoever stays on, there is no sin on him, if his aim is to do good and obey Allah (fear Him), and know that you will surely be gathered unto Him.} I 1 * Muslim 4 :2068. 121 Al-Hakim 2:277.

573 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 Ad-Diyli: 5! 'fc jr^ If) (^!^ ui <3^5 fdj“ «The days of Mina (Tashriq) are three. Those who hasten in two days then there is no sin in it, and those who delay (i.e., remain in Mina for a third day) then there is no sin in it. a Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah’s Messenger jg said: «<S»l Ji'j pjd, jtji-H fd» lThe days of Tashriq are days of eating and remembering Allah. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah’s Messenger^ sent ‘Abdullah bin Hudhafah to Mina proclaiming: « > <iiAj js-i fd »;i\$.i* t yy^ •" * * ' ' “Do not fast these days (i.e., Tashriq days), for they are days of eating, drinking and remembering Allah the Exalted and Most Honored . 12 ’ The Appointed Days Miqsam said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Appointed Days are the days of Tashriq, four days: the day of the Sacrifice (10th of Dhul-Hijjah) and three days after that.*3 ’ This opinion was also reported of Ibn ‘Umar, Ibn Az-Zubayr, Abu Musa, ‘Ata’, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Yahya bin Abu Kathir, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Az-Zuhri, Ar-Rabi’ bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Malik bin Anas, and others. *’ In addition, the apparent meaning of the following Ayah supports this opinion: 4But whosoever hastens to leave in two days, there is no sin on ^ Abu Dawud 2 :485 At-Tabari 4:211. 131 At-Tabari 4:213. 141 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :547-549.

574 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir him and whosoever stays on, there is no sin on him.} So the Ayah hints to the three days after the day of Sacrifice. Allah’s statement: -j ' .it \f^=,%} iAnd remember Allah during the Appointed Days directs remembering Allah upon slaughtering the animals, after the prayers, and by Dhikr (supplication) in general. It also includes Takbir and remembering Allah while throwing the pebbles every day during the Tashriq days. A Hadith that Abu Dawud and several others collected states: 4ii /i jUJi ^>5 uTaiuaf around the House, Sa'f between As-Safd and Al- Marwah and throwing the pebbles were legislated so that Allah is remembered in Dhikr. When mentioning the first procession (refer to 2:199) and the second procession of the people upon the end of the Hajj season, when they

start to return to their areas, after they had gathered during the rituals and at the standing places, Allah said, iand obey Allah (fear Him), and know that you will surely be gathered unto Him.} Similarly, Allah said: iAnd it is He Wlw has created you on the earth, and to Him you shall be gathered back.} (23:79)
cr v <i'j J~A-, JfjVi j iA-* dy 'j*_> m Abu Dawud 2 :447

£>jij >/rr t-4 ^dii 4204. Am/ o/mankind there is he whose speech may please you (O Muhammad jg), in this worldly life, and he calls Allah to witness as to that which is in his heart, yet he is the most quarrelsome of the opponents. 4205. And when he turns away (from you O Muhammad sg), his effort in the land is to make mischief therein and to destroy the crops and the cattle, and Allah likes not mischief>. 4206. And when it is said to him, "Fear Allah", he is led by arrogance to (more) crime. So etough for him is Hell, and worst indeed is that place to rest!} 4207. And of tnankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is full of kindness to (His) servants.} The Characteristics ofthe Hypocrites As-Suddi said that these Ayat were revealed about Al- Akhnas bin Shariq Ath-Thaqafi who came to Allah's Messenger jg and announced his Islam although his heart concealed otherwise. Ibn 'Abbas narrated that these Ayat were revealed about some of the hypocrites who criticized Khubayb and his companions who were killed during the Rajl' incident. 12 ' Thereafter, Allah sent down His condemnation of the hypocrites and His praise for Khubayb and his companions: 4«ii — 4And of mankind is he wlv would sell himself, seeking the pleasure ofAllah .} It was also said that they refer to the hypocrites and the believers in general.'31 This is the opinion of Qatadah, At-Tabari 4:229. ' When 'Adal and Qarah tribes killed the ten Companions whom the Prophet 5& sent to teach them the Qur'an and Islam ,3) At-Tabari 4:230.

Mujahid, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and several others, and it is correct. Ibn Jarir related that Al-Qurazi said that Nawf Al-Bikali, who used to read (previous Divine) Books said, "I find the description of some members of this Ummah in the previously revealed Books of Allah: they (hypocrites) are people who use the religion to gain material benefit. Their tongues are sweeter than honey, but their hearts are more bitter than Sabir (a bitter plant, aloe). They show the people the appearance of sheep while their hearts hide the viciousness of wolves. Allah said, They dare challenge Me, but they are deceived by Me. I swear by Myself that I will send a Fitnah (trial, calamity) on them that will make the wise man bewildered.' I contemplated about these statements and found them in the Qur'an describing the hypocrites: iAtid of mankind there is he whose speech may please you (O Muhammad j&), in this worldly life, and he calls Allah to witness as to that which is in his heart,^ This statement by Al-Qurazi is Hasan Sahih. Allah said: 4 . . .and he calls Allah to witness as to that which is in his heart,} This Ayah indicates that such people pretend to be Muslims, but defy Allah by the disbelief and hypocrisy that their hearts conceal. Similarly Allah said: Si J.Q1 Si iThey may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them)from Allah.} (4:108) This Tafsir was reported from Ibn 'Abbas*2 * by Ibn Ishaq. It was also said that the Ayah means that when such people announce their Islam, they swear by Allah that what is in their hearts is the same of what their tongues are 111 At-Tabari 4:232. 121 At-Tabari 4:230.

577Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) pronouncing. This is also a correct meaning for the Ayah that was chosen by 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. It is also the choice of Ibn Jarir who related it to Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid. Allah knows best. Allah said: jit iYet he is the most Aladd of the opponents.} (2:204) The Ayah used the word Aladd here, which literally means 'wicked' (here it means

‘quarrelsome’). A variation of the word Ludda was also used in another Ayah: ﴿3 So that you (Muhammad) warn with it (the Qur'an) a Ludda people.﴾ (19:97) Hence, a hypocrite lies, alters the truth when he quarrels and does not care for the truth. Rather, he deviates from the truth, deceives and becomes most quarrelsome. It is reported in Sahih that Allah's Messenger said: *لئلا تتكلموا بغير ما علمتم ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق* (lilj t jji- juU- lijj iCjYS •tAi- IS) jSiLjI SSl «77ie signs of a hypocrite are three : Whenever he speaks, he tells a lie. Whenever he promises, he always breaks it (his promise). If you have a dispute with him, he is most quarrelsome.*™ Imam Bukhari reported that ‘A’ishah narrated that the Prophet said: *جئوا بغير ما علمتم ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق ولا تأكلوا مما لم يذكر لكم من الرزق* j)8 The most hated person to Allah is he who is Aladd and Khasim (meaning most quarrelsome).*™ Allah then said: At-Tabari 4 :233 121 Fath Al-Bari 1:111. 131 Fath Al-B&ri 8:36.

And when he turns away (from you O Muhammad), he struggles in the land to make mischief therein and to destroy the crops and the cattle, and Allah likes not mischief. ^ This Ayah indicates that such persons are deviant in the tongue, evil in the deeds, their words are fabricated, their belief is wicked and their works are immoral. The Ayah used the (Arabic word) Sa'a (literally. Tries' or 'intends'). This word was also used to describe Pharaoh: *فإذا فرغنا من هذه الآية، قال يا موسى إنما أنا بشر مثلكم، ولكني آتيتك بالبينات وأنا آتيتك بالبرهان* if# a» pijj L»1 JUi rr 4 - ^5^A 4 AThen he turned his back, Yas'a (striving hard against Allah) Then he gathered his people and cried aloud saying, 'I am your lord, most high.' So Allah, seized him with a punishing example for his last and first transgression. Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for whosoever fears Allah. (79:22-26) [Sa'a was also used in the Ayah]: *4^ S' J' ot 'H <0 you who believe (Muslims)! When the call is proclaimed for the Salah (prayer) on the day of Friday (Jumu'ah prayer), As'aiu come to the remembrance of Allah.﴾ (62:9) This Ayah means, '(when the call to the Friday prayer is announced) intend and then proceed to attend the Friday prayer.' We should mention that hastening to the mosque is condemned by the Sunnah (as this is another meaning for the word Sa'a): *Ujjlj jUib UjJt ISLsjj iii» iWhen you come to attend the prayer, do not come in a Sa't (haste). Rather, come to it while walking at ease and in peace (or grace). |1 ' The hypocrite has no motive in this life but to cause mischief and to destroy the crops and the offspring, including what the animals produce and what the people depend on for their livelihood. Mujahid said, "If the hypocrite strives for mischief in Muslim 1 :420**

579 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) in the land, Allah prevents the rain from falling and thus the crops and the offspring perish.” The Ayah continues: *it 44 v &f} i...and Allah likes not mischief. that is, Allah does not like those who possess these characteristics, or those who act like this. Rejecting Advice is Characteristic of the Hypocrites Allah said: iAnd when it is said to him, "Fear Allah", he is led by arrogance to (more) crime.﴾ This Ayah indicates that when the hypocrite, who deviates in his speech and deeds, is advised and commanded to fear Allah, refrain from his evil deeds and adhere to the truth, he refuses and becomes angry and outraged, as he is used to doing evil. This Ayah is similar to what Allah said: **» *. ,yrj 4 it &T # <& iAnd when Our clear verses are recited to them, you will notice a denial on the faces of the disbelievers! They are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our verses to them. Say: "Shall I tell you of something worse than that? The Fire (of Hell) which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved, and it is indeed that destination!﴾ (22:72) This is why in this Ayah, Allah said: *JliJj <So enough for him is Hell, and worst indeed is that place to rest} meaning, the Fire is enough punishment for the hypocrite. The Sincere Believer prefers pleasing Allah Allah said:***

{And of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah.} After Allah described the evil characteristics of the hypocrites, He mentioned the good qualities of the believers. Allah said: ﴿وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَبْتِغِي الْوَسِيلَةَ إِلَى اللَّهِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾ (2:177) {And of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Anas, Said bin Musayyib, Abu ‘Uthman An-Nahdi, ‘Ikrimah and several other scholars said that this Ayah was revealed about Suhayb bin Sinan Ar-Rumi. When Suhayb became a Muslim in Makkah and intended to migrate (to Al-Madinah), the people (Quraysh) prevented him from migrating with his money. They said that if he forfeits his property, he is free to migrate. He abandoned his money and preferred to migrate, and Allah revealed this Ayah about him. ‘Umar bin al-Khattab and several other Companions met Suhayb close to the outskirts of Al-Madinah at Al-Harrah (flat lands with black stones). They said to him, “The trade has indeed been successful.” He answered them, “You too, may Allah never allow your trade to fail. What is the matter?” ‘Umar told him that Allah has revealed this Ayah (2:207) about him. It was also reported that Allah’s Messenger ﷺ said, “The trade has been successful, O Suhayb!” 1 ^

The meaning of the Ayah (2:207) includes every Mujahid in the way of Allah. Allah said in another Ayah: ﴿وَاللَّهُ يَشْتَرِي مِنْ الْمُحْسِنِينَ﴾ (9:11) {Verily, Allah has purchased of the believers their lives and their properties for (the price) that theirs shall be the Paradise. They fight in Allah's cause, so they kill (others) and are killed. It is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an. And who is truer to his covenant than Allah?} At-Tabari 4 :248

than Allah? Then rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.} (9:11) When Hisham bin ‘Amr penetrated the lines of the enemy, some people criticized him. Umar bin al-Khattab and Abu Hurayrah refuted them and recited this Ayah: ﴿وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَبْتِغِي الْوَسِيلَةَ إِلَى اللَّهِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾ (2:177) {And of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is full of kindness to (His) servants.} If you do not follow the footsteps of Shaytan (Satan). Verily, he is to you a plain enemy.} (4:76) Then if you slide back after the clear signs (Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, and this Qur'an and Islam) have come to you, then know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise}. Entering Islam in its entirety is obligated Allah commands His servants who believe in Him and have faith in His Messenger to implement all of Islam’s legislation and law, to adhere to all of its commandments, as much as they can, and to refrain from all of its prohibitions. ‘Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, and also Mujahid, Tawtis, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Ikrimah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said that Allah’s statement: ﴿وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَبْتِغِي الْوَسِيلَةَ إِلَى اللَّهِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾ (2:177) means Islam. 111 Allah’s statement: ﴿وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَبْتِغِي الْوَسِيلَةَ إِلَى اللَّهِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾ (2:177) means, in its entirety. This is the Tafsir of Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al-‘Aliyah, ‘Ikrimah, Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak. 12 At-Jabari 4 :252, Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :584-585 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :586-588.

583 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Verily, he is to you an open enemy. Allah said: ﴿وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَبْتِغِي الْوَسِيلَةَ إِلَى اللَّهِ بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾ (2:177) {And of mankind is he who would sell himself, seeking the pleasure of Allah.} meaning, if you deviate from the Truth after clear proofs have been established against you, then know that Allah is All-Mighty} in His punishment, and no one can escape His vengeance or defeat Him. 4 All-Wise} in His decisions, actions and rulings. Hence Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas said, “He is Mighty in His vengeance, Wise in His decision.”* 11 J1> (faj J* jit ij "iif J 4210. Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels? (Then) the case

would be already judged. And to Allah return all matters (far decision).} Do not delay embracing the Faith 4D0 they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels?} on the Day of Resurrection to judge the early and the latter creations. Allah shall then reward each according to his or her deeds; and whoever does good shall see it, and whoever does evil shall see it. This is why Allah said: 4&\& fS& & } 4(Then) the case would be already judged. And to Allah return all matters (far decision).} *** Ibn Abi yatim 2 :591

584 Tafstr Ibt Kathir mu» rr mm J J^4*..^* > \$' ^ Jj »Zj—ili~?(3—" j 'Cj*L>-L» _Xj*jy* .Jjt ijJT jUS*vOo a «' _y,»_Si_ji \ ^ Similarly, Allah said: & JoVl J'i t' H %> dS Jfcif; J& ;% ;£fc *; / • -V t <" M •" ty** » tiv • jOfI i <in\ i cjl^s ^ 1-^*3 ** l -» »>-^#.UU ^|«A l£ Aii^j i j<>J^ aJs L*j |^} -j: *: L^" - ^j¥£SjKs3«S6yi^, ' ?\i' \ > -; -i-' <-'?*•. 4jjlj^i ,4_«z \^y_uij > u_>a>£J»-lyyjj \$0 #4\$vsX^0^ :ii« ;n •*: /-v-1-V-^"«" y^s.^ Z1 * • # ^ »Z . J • Z^, {ftp> . Afz^j 4»\O^i j Crj 5&^ •f . z*z jV- 4x^ 4Nay! When the earth is ground to powder. And your Lord comes with the angels in rows. And Hell will be brought near that Day. On that Day will man remember, but how will that remembrance (then) avail him?) (89:21-23) and: 3# <J % £) 3& \$& '&) *t£ 4Do they then wait for anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord (Allah) should come, or that some of the signs of your Lord should come (i.e., portents of the Hour, e.g., rising of the sun from the west!) (6:158) Abu Jafar Razi reported that Abu Al-'Aliyah narrated that: 12'j oj ij "lit jt4'Jf, ol "Sfy oj>k; \$j,) iDo they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them over the shadows of the clouds and the angels?} means, the angels will descend on the shadows of clouds, while Allah comes as He wills.' ' Some of the reciters read it, m At-Jabari 4 :264

Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them and also the angels over the shadows of the clouds. This is similar to Allah's other statement: <:£»& \$\$\$2 4And (remember) the Day when the heaven shall be rent asunder with clouds, and the angels will be sent down, with a grand descending.> (25:25) ill' oji it t* Si Jjrl Lr'J Cji -Hre'* di'Zr-\ Xjf. ijSJI 05 Oj LijH L/jj) ^3 jf Ju J..*.. / v x >>•/ ^ . *5 -'if** 5"tf -»/ *>—i iy* (3jjJ, AUy ^_y >^3j> 4211. Ask the Children of Israel how many clear Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) We gave them. And whoever changes Allah's favor after it has come to him, [e.g., renounces the religion of Allah (Islam) and accepts Kufr (disbelief)] then surely, Allah is severe in punishment 4212. Beautified is the life of this world for those who disbelieve, and they mock at those who believe. But those who have Taqwa, will be above them on the Day of Resurrection. And Allah gives (of His bounty, blessings, favors, and honors on the Day of Resurrection) to whom He wills without limit. The Punishment for changing Allah's Favor and mocking the Believers Allah mentioned that the Children of Israel, were witnesses to many clear signs that attest to the truth of Moses regarding what he was sent with for them. They witnessed his hand (when it became lit with light), his parting the sea, his striking the rock (and water flowed from the rock), the clouds that shaded them during the intense heat, the manna and the quails, and so forth. These signs attested to the existence of the Creator and the truth of Moses by whose hand these signs appeared. Yet, so many among them changed Allah's favor, by preferring disbelief to faith and by ignoring Allah's favors,

JL.X^* iii jli 4j«Xk> -* Jju £j* fIS Xmw Jxj &j} 4And whoever changes Allah's favor after it had come to him, then surely, Allah is severe in punishment. Similarly, Allah said about the disbelievers of

Quraysh: -j'1 1 \$ iddo jilJ j) > jjj' C^4>j iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will bum, - and what an evil place to settle in!} (14:28, 29) Then Allah states that He has made the life of this world beautiful for the disbelievers who are satisfied with it, who collect wealth, but refrain from spending it on what they have been commanded, which could earn them Allah's pleasure. Instead, they ridicule the believers who ignore this life and who spend whatever they earn on what pleases their Lord. The believers spend seeking Allah's Face, and this is why they have gained the ultimate happiness and the best share on the Day of the Return. Therefore, they will be exalted above the disbelievers at the Gathering Place, when they are gathered, during the resurrection and in their final destination. The believers will reside in the highest grades in the utmost highs, while the disbelievers will reside in the lowest of lows (in the Fire). This is why Allah said: iAnd Allah gives to whom He wills without limit.} This Ayah indicates that Allah gives sustenance to whomever He wills of His servants without count or limit in this and the Hereafter. A Hadith has stated (that Allah said): "O son of Adam! Spend (in Allah's cause) and 1 (Alldlt) will spend on i/om.s111 I 1 * Al-Humaydi 2 :459

The Prophet jg said: w*i) J.yl\& 'jXc% j*. ji!u «0 Bilal! Spend and do not fear deprivation from the Owner of the Throne .»11 Allah said: J > > .*> />< J43 jcP- Oj 3 4...and whatsoever you spend of anything (in Allah's cause), He will replace it.} (34:39) In addition, it is reported in the Sahih (that the Prophet jg said): (>-(11' : LLa.i)-l ^ ovj »UJl ^ j'Jy ^15-LLo jit «UL ISLOi ui :^Ml .lit «Every day two angels come down from heavens and one of them says, 'O Allah! Compensate every person who spends in Your cause,' and the other (angel) says, 'O Allah! Destroy every miser .'»21 Also in the Sahih: C—: l l»j iC-itti oisi U Ml jJU vlii (JLa • j^j vllJi ic— o~s. .'o' Uj ic-ILli »Tlie son of Adam says, 'My money, my money!' Yet, what is your money except that which you eat and use up, wear and tear, and spend in charity and thus keep (in your record). Other than that, it will go away and will be left for the people (the inheritors) In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that the Prophet jg said: **J L^jj < aj Jli M JU_j t<J jls M fjA jls DjJlt aThe Dunya (life of this world) is the residence of those who have no residence, the wealth of those who have no wealth, and it is harvested by those who have no sense of reason. *l4] AMabarani 10:192. ,2) Fath Al-Bari 3 :357 131 Muslim 4 :2273 ,41 Ahmad 6:71.

589Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Allah's statement: ^Mankind was one community} means; "They all had the guidance. Then: 4)1 i^vi They disputed and Allah sent Prophets. The first to be sent was Nuh." 'Abdur-Razzaq reported that Abu Hurayrah commented on: 44% « l££2JQ iThen Allah by His leave guided those who believed to the truth of that wherein they differed.} saying that the Prophet jg said: j*4*' J«j Vyi-i Jjl O 5^ 11 \y>£>.\ IXJ 4)1 UJlfi oU-j 0 ; ULi Ijjji li*j u lii iij 4)1 Ulo^i o ^jjl tJL^i n&u&j ji joj; «We are f/ie /asf (nation), but the first (foremost) on the Day of Resurrection We are the first people to enter Paradise, although they (Jews and Christians) have been given the Book before us and we after them. Allah has guided us to the truth wherever they disputed over it. This is the day (Friday) that they disputed about, Allah guided us to it. So, the people follow us, as tomorrow is for the Jews and the day after is for the Christians. »2) Ibn Wahb related that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his father said about the Ayah: >,>' ce *j ijUi-t Q i£>l* ojyi' 4)t iThen Allah by His leave guided those who believed to the truth of that wherein they differed.} They disputed about the day of Congregation (Friday). The l1 ' 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :82. 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :82

Jews made it Saturday while the Christians chose Sunday. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad jg to Friday. They also disputed about the true Qiblah. The Christians faced the east while the Jews faced Bayt Al-Maqdis. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad sg to the true Qiblah (Ka'bah in Makkah). They also disputed about the prayer, as some of them bow down, but do not prostrate, while others prostrate, but do not bow down. Some of them pray while talking and some while walking. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad jg to the truth. They also disputed about the fast; some of them fast during a part of the day, while others fast from certain types of foods. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad sg to the truth. They also disputed about Ibrahim. The Jews said, 'He was a Jew,' while the Christians considered him Christian. Allah has made him a Haniyfan Musliman. Allah has guided the Ummah of Muhammad sg to the truth. They also disputed about 'Isa. The Jews rejected him and accused his mother of a grave sin, while the Christians made him a god and the son of God. Allah made him by His Word and a spirit from (those He created) Him. Allah guided the Ummah of Muhammad jg to the truth." Allah then said: 44%£ by His leave} meaning, "By His knowledge of them and by what He has directed and guided them to,' according to Ibn Jarir,² ' Also: \$And Allah guides whom He wills} means from among His creation. (Allah said:) fa .to the straight way} meaning, He commands the decision and the clear proof. Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported that 'A'ishah narrated that when Allah's Messenger jg used to wake up at night to pray, he would say: m At-Tabari 4:284. 121 At-Tabari 4 :286

^ ui4@' * l Ar4^**i «-> l»j italic- ^ (»^** C«JI lojljJLSI} »p.j; ..4 «UJ^ t5^ kiU[nilta^ J»Jl «0 Af/d/i, f/ ie Lord of (angels) JibrH, Mika'U and lsrdfil, Creator of the heavens and earth and Knower of the seen and the unseen. You judge between Your servants regarding wlwt they have disputed in, so guide me to what have been the subject of dispute of the truth by Your leave. Indeed, You guide whom You will to the straight path, u A Du'a reads: 'tAtaC Ji>dl UjlJ liljlj 1 15^ Ujl «uujj&h d^ .ij , di. u_£ii "O Allah! Show us the truth as truth, and bestow adherence to it on us. Show us the evil as evil, and make us stay away from it, and do not confuse us regarding the reality of evil so that we will not be led astray by it, and make us leaders for the believers .d*2 ' \$2 jKtf« !£ U\$& tSC tjStJG J ft iffCtj\$ 'J* a sr^^^ iiscu& ^ 4,214. Or think you that you will enter Paradise without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah?" Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!} Victory only comes after succeeding in the Trials Allah said: 4'i^ ijSiJc jt ?.:jL 40r think you that you will enter Paradise} ^ Muslim 1 :534 121 TakhrijAl-Ihya'3:1418.

before you are tested and tried just like the nations that came before you? This is why Allah said: &£2£u « l;£ js 4 ...without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments} meaning, illnesses, pain, disasters and hardships. Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Murrah Al-Hamdani, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-RabT, As- Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that iAl-Ba'sd'} means poverty.' Ibn 'Abbas said that \$...and Ad-Darra'} means ailments. 4and were so shaken} for fear of the enemy, and were tested, and put to a tremendous trial. An authentic Hadith narrated that Khabbab bin Al-Aratt said, "We said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Why do you not invoke Allah to support us? Why do you not supplicate to Allah for us?' He said: 4_-l3 jlS' jlS j* jl" , * x (' ^ __ • , ~ 1 IT , ..\l C- \ \ ; La .Li l l l a l* aL LjLajJ LAUj .1 1/ . ji- JLi "The saw would be placed on the middle of the head of one of those who

were before you (believers) and he would be sawn until his feet, and he would be combed with iron combs between his skin and bones, yet that would not make him change his religion .« He then said: aJUI i -y. fs/fo I IjLi '4>\ jfalj i <ujl 111 m Ibn Abi Hatim 2:616.

593 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) iBij Allah! This matter (religion) will spread (or expand) by Allah until the traveler leaves San'a' to Hadramawt (both in Yemen, but at a great distance from each other) fearing only Allah and then the wolf for the sake of his sheep. You are just a hasty people .i 1 ' And Allah said: Oi *i>& Jaj tSX i 3 3 iEH\ 4' t (j&tj iyirf ill! jJyii iAlif-Ldm-Mvn . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested? And We indeed tested those who were before than. And Allah will certainly make (it) known (the truth of) those who are true, and iwill certainly make (it) known (the falsehood of) those who are liars.) (29:1-3) The Companions experienced tremendous trials during the battle of Al-Ahzab (the Confederates). Allah said: % pi& S6 ps * fit h) j>; \$:>:<&. \$ 4(2 & sjisj ^1 tilAy tay UoV (try1* ? ttjb 4W/ie?i they came upon you from above you and from below you, and when the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah. There, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking. And whai the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease (of doubts) said: "Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!") (33:10-12) When Heraclius asked Abu Sufyan, "Did you fight him (Prophet Muhammad)?" He said, "Yes." Heraclius said, "What was the outcome of warfare between you?" Abu Sufyan said, "Sometimes we lose and sometimes he loses." He said, "Such is the case with Prophets, they are tested, but the final victory is theirs.",²! Allah's statement: 111 Fath Al-Bari 6:716. 121 Fath Al-Bari 9:25.

594 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr j2> i...without (such) (trials) as came to those who passed away before you} meaning, their way of life. Similarly, Allah said: iThen We destroyed men stronger (in power) than these - and the example of the ancients has passed away (before them)} (43:8) and: 4\$ jy*& '>*** jMj Sf-f jj* ifo ^ . . .were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah."} They pleaded (to Allah) for victory against their enemies and invoked Him for aid and deliverance from their hardships and trials. Allah said: 4*r?j\$ 61 Vty 4Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!} Allah said: iVerily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief.} (94:5, 6) So just as there is hardship, its equal of relief will soon arrive. This is why Allah said: r}& ol vty 4Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!} 4 'ii 6^» _/»- ert jL«55 i215. They ask you (O Muhammad jg) what they should spend. Say: "Whatever you spend of good must be for parents and kindred and orphans and Al-Masakin (the poor) and the wayfarer, and whatever you do of good deeds, truly, Allah

595 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) rJj rt am# ^ knows it well jajJjcPj[>i3a£_3'o^fv^s-L-;c£ V.iS*- ^ '->-4^-J 'j>jf^ *j&\£Zj^te^jzzLfZcj£&- \ \$ i-sr Who deserves the Nafaqah (Spending or Charity) Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah was revealed about the voluntary charity. 111 The Ayah means, They ask you (O Muhammad \$yg) how they should spend, ' as Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid have stated. So, Allah explained it for them, saying: S'A'Ab* j& IA, b 5j) o&^b t&f) otj/V'j ii& iSay: "Whatever you spend of good must be for parents and kindred and orphans and Al-Masakin and the wayfarer,"} meaning, spend it on these categories or areas. Similarly, a Hadith states (that those who deserve one's generosity the most, Eire): ailuil h&\ 'J iiu'ij itiiJ brij vlufit «Your mother, father, sister,

brother, the closest and then the farthest (relatives) .»,2i Maymun bin Mihran once recited this Ayah (2:215) and commented, “These are the areas of spending. Allah did not mention among them the drums, pipe, wooden pictures, or the 111 Ibn AbiHatim 2:619. I2] Al-Hakim 3:611.

597Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) required to march forth, then march forth .a111 Allah’s statement: 4...though you dislike it} means, ‘Fighting is difficult and heavy on your hearts.’ Indeed, fighting is as the Ayah describes it, as it includes being killed, wounded, striving against the enemies and enduring the hardship of travel. Allah then said: !#5 J &*>} 4 . . .and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you meaning, fighting is followed by victory, dominance over the enemy, taking over their lands, money and offspring. Allah continues: 4 and that you like a thing which is badfor you .} This Ayah is general in meaning. Hence, one might covet something, yet in reality it is not good or beneficial for him, such as refraining from joining the Jihad, for it might lead to the enemy taking over the land and the government. Then, Allah said: X p 'if# 4Alldh knows, but you do not know.} meaning, He has better knowledge than you of how things will turn out to be in the end, and of what benefits you in this earthly life and the Hereafter. Hence, obey Him and adhere to His commands, so that you may acquire the true guidance. •* if u* JLij jS JWSi jio Jla pp x; jiif S, ‘if ie iij *4\$ r£Pi> £& •>*'? / 'V * // \ , *4* jlllf iLijlj }^% Qif 4 ^ liljdjl if 4 ijffl SrjJfj \pXi ol 111 FathAl-Bari4:56.

598 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4 .N\,j—?;) Jji* «Ji’j «UI •- ~-j 4217. They ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) but a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankind from following the way of Allah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing." And they will never cease fighting you until they turn you back from your religion (Islamic Monotheism) if they can. And whosoever of you turns back from his religion and dies as a disbeliever, then his deeds will be lost in this life and in the Hereafter, and they will be the dwellers of the Fire. They will abide therein forever.} 4218. Verily, those who have believed, and those who have emigrated (for Allah's religion) and have striven hard in the way of Allah, all these hope for Allah’s mercy. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Merciful.} The Nahhlah Military Maneuvers, and the Ruling on Fighting during the SacredMonths Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Jundub bin ‘Abdullah said: Allah’s Messenger jg assembled a group of men under the command of Abu ‘Ubaydah bin Jarrah. When he was about to march, he started crying for the thought of missing Allah’s Messenger j\$. Consequently, the Messenger jg relieved Abu ‘Ubaydah from command, appointed ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh instead, gave him some written instructions and commanded him not to read the instructions until he reached such and such area. He also said to ‘Abdullah: «Do not compel any of your men to continue marching with you thereafter . When ‘Abdullah read the instructions, he recited Istitjd [saying, Truly I to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return’; and refer to (2:156)] and said, “I hear and obey Allah and His Messenger.” He then told his companions the story and read the instructions to them, and two men went back while the rest remained. Soon after, they found Ibn Hadrami

599Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) (one of the disbelievers of Quraysh) and killed him not knowing that that day was in Rajab or Jumadi (where Rajab is the Sacred Month). The polytheists said to the Muslims, “You have committed murder in the Sacred Month.” Allah then revealed: i~2, 3vSi ji JI5 iThey ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great

(transgression)...”^ Abdul-Malik bin Hisham, who compiled the Sirah (life story of the Prophet j§), related that Ziyad bin ‘Abdullah Bakka’i said that Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar Al-Madani wrote in his book on the Sirah, “Allah’s Messenger jg sent ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh bin Riyab Al-Asadi in Rajab, after he (the Prophet jg) came back from the first battle of Badr. The Prophet sent eight people with him, all from among the Muhajirun and none from the Ansar. He also gave him some written instructions and ordered him not to read them until he marched for two days. ‘Abdullah should then read the instructions and march to implement them, but should not force any of those who were with him to accompany him. The companions of ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh were all from the Muhajirun, from the tribe of Banu ‘Abd Shams bin ‘Abd Manaf, there was Abu Hudhayfah bin TJtbah bin Rabi’ah bin ‘Abd Shams bin ‘Abd Manaf. From their allies, there was ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh, who was the commander of the army unit, and TJkkashah bin Mihsan from the tribe of Banu Asad bin Khuzaymah. From the tribe of Banu Nawfal bin ‘Abd Manaf, there was TJtbah bin Ghazwan bin Jabir, one of their allies. From the tribe of Banu Zuhrah bin Kilab, there was Sa’d bin Abu Waqqas. From Banu KaTa, there were their allies: ‘Adi bin ‘Amr bin Ar-RabPah not from the tribe of Ibn Wa’il; Wfiqid bin ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abd Manaf bin ‘Ann bin Thalabah bin Yarbu’ from Banu Tamlm; and Khalid bin Bukair from the tribe of Banu Sa’d bin Layth, Suhayl bin Bayda’ from Banu Al-Harith bin Fihir was also among them. When ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh marched for two days, he opened and read the I 1 * Ibn Abi H§tim 2 :628.

600 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir (Prophet’s) instructions, “When you read these instructions, march until you set camp at Nakhlah between Makkah and At-Ta’if. There, watch the movements of the caravan of Quraysh and collect news about them for us.” When ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh read the document, he said, “I hear and obey.” He then said to his companions, “Allah’s Messenger % has commanded me to march forth to Nakhlah to watch the movements of the caravan of Quraysh and to inform him about their news. He has prohibited me from forcing any of you (to go with me). So, those who seek martyrdom, they should march with me. Those who dislike the idea of martyrdom, let them turn back. Surely, I will implement the command of Allah’s Messenger s&.” He and his companions continued without any of them turning back. ‘Abdullah entered the Hijaz area (western Arabia) until he reached an area called Buhran, close to Furu’. There, Sa’d bin Abu Waqqas and ‘Utbah bin Ghazwan lost the camel that they were riding in turns, and they went back to search for it while ‘Abdullah bin Jahsh and the rest of his companions continued until they reached Nakhlah. Then, a caravan belonging to the Quraysh passed by carrying raisins, food stuff and some trade items for the Quraysh. ‘Amr bin Hadrami, whose name was ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbad, was in the caravan, as well as Uthman bin ‘Abdullah bin Al-Mughirah and his brother Nawfal bin ‘Abdullah from the tribe of Makhzum, and Al-Hakam bin Kaysan, a freed slave of Hisham bin Al-Mughirah. When they saw the Companions they were frightened, but when they saw Ukkashah bin Mihsan their fears subsided, since his head was shaved. They said, “These people seek the ‘Umrah, so there is no need to fear them.” The Companions conferred among themselves. That day was the last day in the (sacred) month of Rajab. They said to each other, “By Allah! If you let them pass, they will soon enter the Sacred Area and take refuge in it from you. If you kill them, you will kill them during the Sacred Month.” They at first hesitated and did not like to attack them. They then began encouraging themselves and decided to kill whomever they could among the disbelievers and to confiscate whatever they had. Hence, Waqid bin ‘Abdullah At-Tamlmi shot an arrow at ‘Amr bin Al-Hadrami and killed him. Uthman bin ‘Abdullah

601 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) and Al-Hakam bin Kaysan gave themselves up, while Nawfal bin 'Abdullah was able to outrun them in flight. Later on, 'Abdullah bin Jahsh and his companions went back to Allah's Messenger jg in Al-Madinah with the caravan and the two prisoners. Ibn Ishaq went on: I was told that some members of the family of 'Abdullah bin Jahsh said that 'Abdullah said to his companions: "Allah's Messenger jg will have one-fifth of what we have confiscated." This occurred before Allah required one- fifth for His Messenger from the war booty. So, 'Abdullah designated one-fifth of the caravan for Allah's Messenger jg and divided the rest among his companions. Ibn Ishaq also stated that at first, when the Sariyah came back to Allah's Messenger he said to them: JIL ja\ Li® "J have not commanded you to conduct warfare during the Sacred Month. He left the caravan and the two prisoners alone and did not take any share of the war booty. When Allah's Messenger % did that, the soldiers from the attack were concerned and felt that they were destroyed, and their Muslim brethren criticized them for what they did. The Quraysh said that Muhammad jg and his Companions violated the sanctity of the Sacred Month and shed blood, confiscated property and took prisoners during it. Those who refuted them among the Muslims who remained in Makkah replied that the Muslims had done that during the month of Shalsan (which is not a sacred month). Meanwhile, the Jews were pleased about what happened to Allah's Messenger fg. They said, ' Amr bin Hadrami was killed by Waqid bin 'Abdullah: 'Amr, means the war has started, Hadrami means the war has come, as for Waqid (bin 'Abdullah): the war has raged (using some of the literal meanings of these names to support their fortune- telling!)." But, Allah made all that turn against them. The people continued talking about this matter, then Allah revealed to His Messenger sg: ip\ tejM ^ c!>i5&&

iThey ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Months. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) but a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankind from following the way of Allah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al- Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing. This Ayah means, If you had killed during the Sacred Month, they {disbelievers of Quraysh} have hindered you from the path of Allah and disbelieved in it. They also prevented you from entering the Sacred Mosque, and expelled you from it, while you are its people, 4 ...a greater (transgression) with Allah} than killing whom you killed among them. Also: 4...and Al-Fitnah is worse than killing .} means, trying to force the Muslims to revert from their religion and re-embrace Kufr after they had believed, is worse with Allah than killing.' Allah said: 4And they will never cease fighting you until they turn you back from your religion (Islamic Monotheism) if they can.} So, they will go on fighting you with unrelenting viciousness. Ibn Ishaq went on: When the Qur'an touched this subject and Allah brought relief to the Muslims instead of the sadness that had befallen them, Allah's Messenger jgr took possession of the caravan and the two prisoners. The Quraysh offered to ransom the two prisoners, TJthman bin 'Abdullah and Hakam bin Kaysan. Allah's Messenger jg said: mt'i I - "I* * ' . ' * » i- tCvI JINe will not accept your ransom until our two companions return safely . meaning Sa'd bin Abu Waqqas and TJtbah bin Ghazwan, "For we fear for their safety with you. If you kill them, we will kill your people." Later on, Sa'd and TJtbah returned safely and

i&nu» ro tSatgu v ^i^r%Qli' Cr?-i oVjj- 34\$P^sfP^LS^Uk ^jXj^LSj |™| tjyjf Jf~g«^J iU3\jl>frvi js 1_J^>tll\,jc jlijj-g^6°“i^y>“ 3J &tyy>&pf\$PZ.\\$ \z&y& i^irj Lt*js^_)1 ijS^oe.*^j|) *)!>< >“UJ \ffo~ai* j_pCSt Allah's Messenger jg accepted the Quraysh's ransom for their prisoners. As for Al-

Hakam bin Kaysan, he became Muslim and his Islam strengthened. He remained with Allah's Messenger ﷺ until he was martyred during the incident at Bir Ma'Onah (when the Prophet ﷺ sent seventy Companions to Najd to teach them Islam, but Banu Sulaim killed them all except two). As for 'Uthman bin 'Abdullah, he went back to Makkah and died there as a disbeliever. Ibn Ishaq went on: When 'Abdullah bin Jahsh and his companions were relieved from their depressing thoughts after the Qur'an was revealed about this subject, they sought the reward of the fighters (in Allah's way). They said, "O Messenger of Allah! We wish that this incident be considered a battle for us, so that we gain the rewards of the Mujahidin." Then, Allah revealed: ⁴ Verily, those who have believed, and those who have emigrated (for Allah's religion) and have striven hard in the way of Allah, all these hope for Allah's mercy. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.

Hence, Allah has greatly elevated their hopes of gaining what they had wished for. They ask you (O Muhammad ﷺ) concerning alcoholic drink and gambling. Say: "In them is a great sin, and (some) benefits far men, but the sin of them is greater than their benefit." And they ask you what they ought to spend. Say: "That which is (spare) beyond your needs." Thus Allah makes clear to you His Laws in order that you may give thought. In (to) this worldly life and in the Hereafter. And they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers. And Allah knows (the one) who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from (the one) who means good (e.g., to save their property). And if Allah had wished, He could have put you into difficulties. Truly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise." The Gradual Prohibition of Khamr (Alcoholic Drink) Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Maysarah said that 'Umar once said, "O Allah! Give us a clear ruling regarding Al-Khamr Allah sent down the Ayah of Surat Al-Baqarah: They ask you (O Muhammad ﷺ) concerning alcoholic drink and gambling. Say: "In them is a great sin..." 'Umar was then summoned and the Ayah was recited to him. Yet, he still said, "O Allah! Give us a clear ruling

regarding Al-Khamr. Then, this Ayah that is in Surat An-

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 604–605]

Nisa' was revealed: Ibn Hishm 2 1252-255 .

O you who believe! Approach not As-Salah (the prayer) when you are in a drutiketi state.} (4:43) Then, when the prayer was called for, a person used to herald on behalf of Allah's Messenger ﷺ, "No drunk person should attend the prayer." Umar was summoned again and the Ayah was recited to him. Yet, he still said, "O Allah! Give us a clear ruling regarding Al-Khamr." Then, the Ayah that is in

Surat Al-Ma'idah was revealed, Umar was again summoned

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 605–618]

and the Ayah was recited to him. When he reached: So, will you not then abstain?} (5:91) he said, "We did abstain, we did abstain."* 11 This is also the narration that Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal collected in their books.12 'Ali bin Al-Madlani and At-Tirmidhi said that the chain of narrators for

this Hadith is sound and authentic. We will mention this Hadith again along with what Imam Ahmad collected by Abu Hurayrah Allah's saying in Surat Al-Ma'idah: 4 j83 ^ £C#5^ <3i> intoxicants and gambling, and Al-Ansdb,131 and Al-Azlam141 are an abomination of Satan's handiwork. So avoid (strictly all) that (abomination) in order that you may be successful.} (5:90) Allah said: iThey ask you (O Muhammad j*) concerning alcoholic drinks and gambling.} As for Al-Khamr, Umar bin al-Khattab, the Leader of the faithful, used to say, "It includes all what intoxicates the mind." We will also mention this statement in the explanation 111 Ahmad 1:531. ' Abu Dawud 4 :79 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :415 , An-Nasal 8 :287 * Altars upon which animals were sacrificed for other than Allah * Arrows used for divination

606 Tahir Ibn Kathir of Surat Al-Ma'idah, along with the topic of gambling. Allah said: iSay : In them is a great sin, and (some) benefits for men.} As for the harm that the Khamr and gambling cause, it affects the religion. As for their benefit, it is material, including benefit for the body, digesting the food, getting rid of the excrements, sharpening the mind, bringing about a joyous sensation and financially benefiting from their sale. Also, (their benefit includes) earnings through gambling that one uses to spend on his family and on himself. Yet, these benefits are outweighed by the clear harm that they cause which affects the mind and the religion. This is why Allah said: 4...but the sin of them is greater than their benefit. This Ayah was the beginning of the process of prohibiting Khamr, not explicitly, but it only implied this meaning. So when this Ayah was recited to 'Umar, he still said, "O Allah! Give us a clear ruling regarding Al-Khamr." Soon after, Allah sent down a clear prohibition of Khamr in Surat Al-Ma'idah: & * jUy *2r at t#: uM * 15 >' 4 fiz\$ C\ &h\ L.J, 40 you who believe! Intoxicants (all kinds of alcoholic drinks), and gambling, and Al-Ansdb, and Al-Azlam are an abomination of Shaytail's handiwork. So avoid (strictly all) that (abomination) in order that you may be successful. Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with intoxicants (alcoholic drinks) and gambling, and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from As-Salath (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} (5 :90 , 9 We will mention this subject, by the will of Allah, when we Ahmad 2:351. [21 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :636.

607 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) explain Surat Al-Ma'idah. Ibn 'Umar, Ash-ShaTii, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Aslam stated that the first Ayah revealed about Khamr was: / 4 j* ./-Jil'j - • f0 ' AThey ask you about Khamr and gambling. Say : "In them there is great sin."} (2:219) Then, the Ayah in Surat An-Nisa' was revealed (on this subject) and then the Ayah in Surat Al-Ma'idah which prohibited Khamr. ili Spending whatever One could spare of his Money on Charity Allah said: AAnd they ask you what they ought to spend. Say: "That which is (spare) beyond your needs."} Al-Hakam said that Miqdam said that Ibn 'Abbas said that this Ayah means, whatever you can spare above the needs of your family. This is also the opinion of Ibn Umar, Mujahid, 'Ata', 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka*b, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Al-QSsim, Salim, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and Ar- Rabi' bin Anas.121 Ibn Jarir related that Abu Hurayrah said that a man said, "O Messenger of Allah! I have a Dinar (a currency)." The Prophet sg said: "Spend it you on yourself.» He said, "I have another Dinar." He said: "Spend it on your wife.* He said, "I have another Dinar." He said: At-Jabari 4:331-336. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :656-657.

uSpend it on your offspring .» He said, "I have another Dinar." He said: «You have better knowledge (meaning how and where to spend it in charity)Jll] Muslim also recorded this Hadith in his Sahth. Muslim recorded that Jabir said that Allah's Messenger jg said to a man: villai If 'ds"1 vviliaSte jJii oji i (jjuali Ijil® JliEaj Iji^j vilirj If jU nilSly (iStorf with yourself and grant it some charity. If anything remains, then spend it on your family. If anything remains, then spend it on your relatives. If anything remains, then spend it like this and like that (i.e., on various charitable purposes)J™ A Hadith states: i iaili (Jhl (jt dll Jjil «O son of Adam! If you spend whatever you can spare, it would be better far you; but ifyou keep it, it would be worse far you. You shall not be blamed far whatever is barely sufficient .»*31 Allah said: QiIf 4 p# iThus Allah makes clear to you His Ayat in order that you may give thought. In (to) this worldly life and in the Hereafter.} meaning, just as He stated and explained these commandments for you, He also explains the rest of His Ayat m At-Tabari 4:340. Muslim 2:692. Muslim no.1036.

regarding the commandments and His promises and warnings, so that you might give thought in this life and the Hereafter.' 'Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Meaning about the imminent demise and the brevity of this life, and the imminent commencement of the Hereafter and its continuity."^ 'I Maintaining the Orphan's Property Allah said: j* j&J ijlij fii'y-li Jlj "Jf js 4And they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "Tire best thing is to work honestly in their property, and ifyou mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers. And Alldlt knows him who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from him who means good (e.g., to save their property). And if Allah had wished. He could have put you into difficulties.} Ibn Jartr reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the Ayat 4And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it.} (6:152) and i\} iVerily, those wlv unjustly eat up the property of orphans, they eat up only fire into their bellies, and they will be burnt in the blazing Fire!} (4: 10) were revealed, those who took care of some orphans, separated their food and drink from the orphans' food and drink. When some of the orphans' food and drink remained, they would keep it for them until they eat it or otherwise get spoiled. This situation was difficult for them and they mentioned this subject to Allah's Messenger fg. Ill At-Jabari 4 :348

^pj4 % &\ * ^ iAnd they ask you concerning orphans. Say: "The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers.} Hence, they joined their food and drink with the food and drink of the orphans." 1 11 This Hadith was also collected by Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak.m Several others said similarly about the circumstances surrounding the revelation of the Ayah (2:220), including Mujahid, 'Ata', Ash-Shahi, Ibn Abu Layla, Qatadah and others among the Salaf and those after them. Ibn Jarir reported that 'A'ishah said, "I dislike that an orphan's money be under my care, unless I mix my food with his food and my drink with his drink." Allah said: iSay: The best thing is to ivork honestly in their property.} meaning, on the one hand (i.e., this is required in any case). Allah then said: i...and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers.} meaning, there is no harm if you mix your food and drink with their food and drink, since they are your brothers in the religion. This is why Allah said afterwards: iAnd Allah knows (the otic) who means mischief (e.g., to swallow their property) from (the one) who means good (e.g., to save their property).} meaning, He knows those whose intent is to cause mischief or righteousness. He also said: 111 At-Tabari 4 :350 121 Abu Dawud 3 :291 , An-Nasal 6 :256 and Al-Hakim 2 :103. 131 At-Tabari 4 :350-353 141 At-Tabari 4 : :355

611 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 iif j l ill its fff i And if Allah had wished, He could have put you into difficulties. Truly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise> meaning, if Allah wills, He will make this matter difficult for you. But, He made it easy for you, and allowed you to mix your affairs with the orphans' affairs in a way that is better. Similarly, Allah said: ^0—* ' J l i And come not near to the orphan's properh/, except to improve it.? (6 :152 Allah has thus allowed spending from the orphan's estate by its executor, in reasonable proportions, on the condition that he has the intention to compensate the orphan later on, when he can afford it. We will mention about it in detail in Surat An-Nisa' by Allah's will. J l ^ f c x d S j J j ; % U y - O j i £ a s 4 i j t J S i ' j J i i j f - j , f f x i 2 2 1 . And do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (idolatresses) till they believe (worship Allah Alone). And indeed a slave woman who believes is better than a (free) Mushrikah (idolatress), even though she pleases you. And give not (your daughters) in marriage to Al-Mushrikfn till they believe (in Allah Alone) and verily, a believing servant is better than a (free) Mushrik (idolator), even though he pleases you. Those (Mushrikin) invite you to the Fire, but Allah invites (you) to Paradise and forgiveness by His leave, and makes His Ayat (proofs, evidences, verses, lessons, signs, revelations, etc.) Hear to mankind that they may remember.)> The Prohibition of marrying Mushrik Men and Women Allah prohibited the believers from marrying Mushrik women who worship idols. Although the meaning is general and includes every Mushrik woman from among the idol worshippers and the People of the Scripture, Allah excluded

the People of the Scripture from this ruling. Allah stated: J t * u w ** 1 ' i) O J ^ (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from those who were given the Scripture (Jeios and Christians) before your time when you have given their due dowry, desiring chastity (i.e., taking them in legal wedlock) not committing illegal sexual intercourse.} (5:5) 'Ali bin Abu Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said about what Allah said: } Attd do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (female idolators) till they believe (worship Allah Alone).} "Allah has excluded the women of the People of the Scripture." 1 11 This is also the explanation of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Makhul, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and others.¹² * Some scholars said that the Ayah is exclusively talking about idol worshippers and not the People of the Scripture, and this meaning is similar to the first meaning we mentioned. Allah knows best. Abu Ja'far bin Jarir (At-Tabari) said, after mentioning that there is Ijma' that marrying women from the People of the Scripture is allowed, "TJmar disliked this practice so that the Muslims do not refrain from marrying Muslim women, or for similar reasons." ' An authentic chain of narrators stated that Shaqlq said: Once Hudhayfah married a Jewish woman and TJmar wrote to him, "Divorce her." He wrote back, "Do you claim that she is not allowed for me so that I divorce her?" He said, "No. But, I fear that you might marry the whores from among them." Ibn Jarir related that Zayd bin Wahb said that TJmar bin Khattab said, "The Muslim man marries the Christian woman, but the Christian man does not marry the Muslim woman." This Hadith has a stronger, authentic chain of narrators than the previous Hadith. 111 At-Tabari 4:362. * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :669-67 1 * At-Tabari 4 :366 * See Al-Tabari 4 :366

Ibn Abu Hatim * said that Ibn "Umar disliked marrying the women from the People of the Scripture. He relied on his own explanation for the Ayah: i And do not marry Al-Mushrikdt (female idolators) till they believe (worship Allah Alone). Al-Bukhari also reported that Ibn "Umar said, "I do not know of a bigger Shirk than her saying that Jesus is her Lord!"*2 Allah said: j i ; u i 3 S . 4 And indeed a slave woman i v h o believes is better than a (free) Mushrikah (female idolators), even though she pleases you.} It is

recorded in the Two Sahths that Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet jg said: oli 'fait \±fSSj l\$JUJ :gf} "A woman is chosen far marriage farfour reasons : her wealth, social status, beauty, and religion. So, marry the religious woman, may your hands be filled with sand (a statement of encouragement) Muslim reported this Hadlth from Jabir.*41 Muslim also reported that Ibn 'Amr said that Allah's Messenger jg said: fiJ\ GiSl "The life of this world is but a delight, and the best of the delights of this earthly Ufa is the righteous wifefa5 Allah then said: 4And give not (your daughters) in marriage to Al-Mushrikin 111 Ibn AbiHatim 2:671. 121 FathAl-Bari 9:326. * Fath Al-Bari 9 :35 , Muslim 2 :1087 Muslim 2:1087. ,5) Muslim 2:9010.

till they believe (in Allah Alone).} meaning, do not marry Mushrik men to believing women. This statement is similar to Allah's statement: iThey are not lawful (wives) for them, nor are they lawful (husbands) for them.} (60:10) Next, Allah said: 4 ...and verily, a believing servant is better than a (free) Mushrik (idolator), even though he pleases you.} This Ayah indicates that a believing man, even an Abyssinian servant, is better than a Mushrik man, even if he was a rich master. 4~M iThose (Al-Mushrikiin) invite you to the Fire} meaning, associating and mingling with the disbelievers makes one love this life and prefer it over the Hereafter, leading to the severest repercussions. Allah said: .but Allah invites (you) to Paradise and forgiveness by His leave} meaning, by His Law, commandments and prohibitions. Allah said: 'tpy* 'P)} .and makes His Aydt clear to mankind that they may remember.} offe jij 'jj J*~i«*)' 4 if fJi jJpi L4- h be ^ ^4 \$ p?\$P Ij. 4222 . They ask you concerning menstruation . Say : "That is an Adhd, therefore, keep away from women during menses and go

615Surah 2. Al-Baaarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 not in unto them till they are purified." And when they have purified themselves, then go in unto them as Allah has ordained far you. Tndy, Allah loves those who turn unto Him in repentance and loves those who purify themselves.} 4223. Your ivives are a tilth far you, so go to your tilth, when or Imv you will, and send (good deeds, or ask Allah to bestow upon you pious offspring) far your ozon selves beforehand. And fear Allah, and know that you are to meet Him (in the Hereafter), and give good tidings to the believers (O Muhammad &).} Sexual Intercourse with Menstruating Women is prohibited Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Jews used to avoid their menstruating women, they would not eat, or even mingle with them in the house. The Companions of the Prophet jg asked about this matter and Allah revealed: (Sr CrVjyj Y} 4 fa ji fa iThey ask you concerning menstruation. Say: "That is an Adlia, therefore, keep azoay from women during metises and go not in unto them till they are purified.} Allah's Messenger^ said: VI^ a'Do everything you zoish, except having sexual intercourse .» When the Jews were told about the Prophet's statement, they said, "What is the matter with this man? He would not hear of any of our practices, but would defy it." Then, Usayd bin Hudayr and 'Abbad bin Bishr came and said, "O Messenger of Allah! The Jews said this and that, should we have sex with our women (meaning, during the menstruation period)?" The face of Allah's Messenger changed color, until the Companions thought that he was angry with them. They left. Soon after, some milk was brought to Allah's Messenger as a gift, and he sent some of it for them to drink. They knew then that Allah's Messenger was not angry with themJ'^ ui Ahmad 3 :132.

616 Tafsir IbtI Kathfr Muslim also reported this Hadlth. Allah said: 4 'Alili 4 .. .therefore, keep envayfrom women during menses meaning, avoid the sexual organ. The Prophet said: •0S&I VI^ 'js iDo anything you wish except having sexual intercourse .s' This is why most of the scholars said that it

is allowed to fondle the wife, except for having sexual intercourse (when she is having her menses). Abu Dawud reported that Ilcrimah related to one of the Prophet's wives that she said that whenever the Prophet wanted to fondle (one of his wives) during her menses, he would cover her sexual organ with something.²¹ Abu JaTar bin Jarir related that Masruq went to 'A'ishah and greeted her, and 'A'ishah greeted him in return. Masruq said, "I wish to ask you about a matter, but I am shy." She replied, "I am your mother and you are my son." He said, "What can the man enjoy of his wife when she is having her menses?" She said, "Everything except her sexual organ."¹³ This is also the opinion of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and 'Ikrimah. One is allowed to sleep next to his wife and to eat with her (when she is having her menses). 'A'ishah said, "Allah's Messenger used to ask me to wash his hair while I was having the menses. He would lay on my lap and read the Qur'an while I was having the period."⁴ It is also reported in the Sahlh that 'A'ishah said, "While having the menses, I used to eat from a piece of meat and give it to the Prophet who would eat from the same place I ate from. I used to have sips of a drink and would then give the cup to the Prophet who would place his mouth where I placed my mouth."⁵ It is also reported in the Two Sahihs that Maymunah bint Muslim 1 :246. ' Abu Dawud 1 : 286. 131 At-Tabari 4:378. 141 Fath Al-Bari 1 :479 ' Muslim 1 :245.

617 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Al-Harith Al-Hilaliyah said, "Whenever the Prophet wanted to fondle any of his wives during the periods (menses), he used to ask her to wear an Zzar (a sheet covering the lower-half of the body)." These are the wordings collected by Al-Bukhari. Similar was reported from 'A'ishah.^{*21} In addition, Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah reported that 'Abdullah bin Sa'd Al-Ansari asked Allah's Messenger sfe, "What am I allowed of my wife while she is having her menses?" He said, "What is above the Izar (a sheet covering the lower-half of the body)." ¹³¹ Hence, Allah's statement: 4...and go not in unto them till they are purified. explains His statement: 4...therefore, keep away from women during menses> Allah prohibited having sexual intercourse with the wife during menstruation, indicating that sexual intercourse is allowed otherwise. Allah's statement: 4And when they have purified themselves, then go in unto them as Allah has ordained for you indicates that men should have sexual intercourse with their wives after they take a bath. The scholars agree that the woman is obliged to take a bath, or to perform Tayammum with sand, if she is unable to use water, before she is allowed to have sexual intercourse with her husband, after the monthly period ends. Ibn 'Abbas said: "4till they are purified^ means from blood, and, ¹¹¹ Path Al-Bari 1 :483 .Muslim 1 :243. ^ Fath Al-Bari 1 :480.Muslim 1 :242. '31 Ahmad 4:342, Abu Dawud 1 : 145, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:415, Ibn Majah 1 :213.

iAttd when they have purified themselves} means with water." This is also the Tafsir of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Al-Layth bin Sa'd and others. Anal Sex is prohibited Allah said: .as Allah has ordained for you.} this refers to Al-Farj (the vagina), as Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and other scholars have stated.^{*2} ' Therefore, anal sex is prohibited, as we will further emphasize afterwards, Allah willing. Abu Razln, 'Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak and others said that: 1., ^£f%} 4...then go in unto them as Allah has ordained for you.} means when they are pure, and not during the menses. Allah said afterwards: iTruly, Allah loves those who turn unto Him in repentance} from the sin even if it was repeated, US iand loves those who purify themselves.} meaning, those who purify themselves from the impurity and the filth that include having sexual intercourse with the wife during the menses and anal sex.

The Reason behind revealing Allah's Statement: "Your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 618–642]

Wives are a Tilth for You." Allah said: 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :682,683 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :684 *3) Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :684 ,685

619 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) iYour wives are a tilth for you,} Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Meaning the place of pregnancy." [Allah then said:] \$py . . .so go to your tilth, when or how you will,} meaning, wherever you wish from the front or from behind, as long as sex takes place in one valve (the female sexual organ), as the authentic Hadiths have indicated. For instance, Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn Al-Munkadir said that he heard Jabir say that the Jews used to claim that if one has sex with his wife from behind (in the vagina) the offspring would become cross-eyed. Then, this Ayah was revealed: «;S4 \$py \%p ly iYour wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or how you will,}™ Muslim and Abu Dawud also reported this Hadith.™ Ibn Abu yatim said that Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir narrated that Jabir bin 'Abdullah told him that the Jews claimed to the Muslims that if one has sex with their wife from behind (in the vagina) their offspring will become cross-eyed. Allah revealed afterwards: #py\$py ly iYour wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or how you will,} Ibn Jurayj (one of the reporters of the Hadlth) said that Allah's Messenger^ said: ij) Jjjj jlS lil iFrom the front or from behind, as long as that occurs in the Farj (vagina).*™ 111 At-Tabari 4:397. 121 FathAl-Bari4:397. ' Muslim 2 :1058, Abu Dawud 2 :618. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :693

Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Ayah, ip iy. iYour wives are a tilthfor you was revealed about some people from the Ansar who came to the Prophet sg and asked him (about having sex with the wife from behind). He said to them: H^& V Have sex with her as you like as long as that occurs in the vaginaJ Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Sabit said: I went to Hafsa bint 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abu Bakr and said, "I wish to ask you about something, but I am shy." She said, "Do not be shy, O my nephew." He said, "About having sex from behind with women." She said, "Umm Salamah told me that the Ansar used to refrain from having sex from behind (in the vagina). The Jews claimed that those who have sex with their women from behind would have offspring with crossed-eyes. When the Muhajirun came to Al-Madlnah, they married Ansar women and had sex with them from behind. One of these women would not obey her husband and said, 'You will not do that until I go to Allah's Messenger jg (and ask him about this matter).' She went to Umm Salamah and told her the story. Umm Salamah said, 'Wait until Allah's Messenger 3^5 comes.' When Allah's Messenger came, the Ansari woman was shy to ask him about this matter, so she left. Umm Salamah told Allah's Messenger the story and he said: «Summon the Ansari womanJ" She was summoned and he recited this Ayah to her: ip4\$ pf-\$p >V iYour wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or how you will .> He added: m Ahmad 1 :268

621 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2) Only in one valve (the vagina) .n"11 ' This Hadith was also collected by At-Tirmidhi who said, "Hasan."21 An-Nasab reported that Ka*b bin 'Alqamah said that Abu An- Nadr said that he asked Nafi', "The people are repeating the statement that you relate from Ibn Umar that he allowed sex with women in their rear (anus)." He said, "They have said a lie about me. But let me tell you what really happened. Ibn Umar was once reciting the Qur'an while I was with

him and he reached the Ayah: *^pi \ %p P t/ i* Your wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or Itoio you will,} He then said, ‘O Nafi‘! Do you know the story behind this Ayah?’ I said, ‘No.’ He said, We, the people of Quraysh, used to have sexual intercourse with our wives from the back (in the vagina). When we migrated to Al-Madlnah and married some Ansari women, we wanted to do the same with them. They disliked it and made a big issue out of it. The Ansari women had followed the practice of the Jews who have sex with their women while they lay on their sides. Then, Allah revealed: *\$pl\$P i* Your wives are a tilth for you, so go to your tilth, when or hmo you will This has an authentic chain of narrators. Imam Ahmad reported that Khuzaymah bin Thabit Al- Khatami narrated that Allah’s Messenger jfe said: *J iUlJl ‘i - lS% - Jijl^ iSil V* «Allah does not shy from the truth - he said it thrice-, do not have anal sex with women . »⁴¹ 111 Ahmad 6:305. 121 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :322 ‘ An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:315. Ahmad 5:215.

This Hadith was collected by An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.’ Abu ‘Isa At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal reported that Ibn ‘Abbas narrated that Allah’s Messenger jfe said: *^jJi si^t j\ y**. Jii Jtii &Allah does not look at a man who had anal sex with another man or a woman .”² ‘ At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib.” This is also the narration that Ibn Hibban collected in his Sahih, while Ibn Hazm stated that this is an authentic Hadith. In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that ‘Ali bin Talaq said, “Allah’s Messenger £?, forbade anal sex with women, for Allah does not shy away from truth.”¹³ ‘ Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi also reported this Hadith and said, “Hasan”.⁴ ‘ Abu Muhammad ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abdur-Rahman Darimi reported in his Musnad that Said bin Yasar Abu Hubab said: I said to Ibn ‘Umar, “What do you say about having sex with women in the rear?” He said, “What does it mean?” I said, “Anal sex.” He said, “Does a Muslim do that?”⁵ ‘ This Hadith has an authentic chain of narrators and is an explicit rejection of anal sex from Ibn ‘Umar. Abu Bakr bin Ziyad Naysaburi reported that Ismail bin Ruh said that he asked Malik bin Anas, “What do you say about having sex with women in the anus?” He said, “You are not an Arab? Does sex occur but in the place of pregnancy? Do it only in the Farj (vagina).” I said, “O Abu ‘Abdullah! They say that you allow that practice.” He said, “They utter a lie about me, they lie about me.” This is Malik’s firm stance on this subject. It is also the view of Said bin Musayyib, Abu Salamah, ‘Ikrimah, Tawus, ‘Ata , Said bin Jubayr, ‘Urwah bin Az-Zubayr, Mujahid bin Jabr, Al-Hasan and other scholars of the Salaf (the Companions and the following two generations An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:316, Ibn Majah 1 :619. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :329 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5:320, Sahih Ibn Hibban 6 :202 131 Ibn Hajr mentioned it in AtrafAl-Musnad 4 :384, but it is not in the published version ‘4 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :274 ‘ Ad-Darimi 1 :277 no. 1143.

623 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (201 - 224) (Part-2 after them). They all, along with the majority of the scholars, harshly rebuked the practice of anal sex and many of them called this practice a Kufr. Allah said: and sendfor your own selves beforehand.} meaning, by performing the acts of worship while refraining from whatever Allah has prohibited for you. This is why Allah said afterwards: *ij& fUt 3 i&& \$* And fear Allah, and know that you are to meet Him (in the Hereafter), meaning, He will hold you accountable for all of your deeds, 4 ...and give good tidings to the believers (O Muhammad &).} meaning, those who obey what Allah has commanded and refrain from what He has prohibited. Ibn Jarir reported that ‘Ata’ said, or related it to Ibn ‘Abbas, 4 ...and sendfor your oivn selves beforehand.} means, mention Allah’s Name, by saying, Bismillah , before having sexual intercourse.”¹¹¹ Al-Bukhari also reported that Ibn ‘Abbas narrated that Allah’s Messenger said: *OUaloJl lilLf pJ.L : Jli iUl Lbl*

jllaLtJI ^ ' ^1 i JIJi jJj U^.; U 01 iljt li] 1 jl g , • ,C ' , ' - z jJLSj 01 i l L* jHaO^l <1 If anyone of you on having sexual relations with his wife said: 'In the Name of Allah. O Allah! Protect us from Satan and also protect what you bestow upon us (i.e., the coming offspring) from Satan,' and if it is destined that they should have a child then, Satan will never be able to harm /iim.»¹²¹ ,M At-Jabari 4:417. ¹²¹ Fath Al-Bari 9 :136

3 %} tjiXJj L}jy ^ • j » ^sulwV ^i)L v . .>- «if» jfe*? ti >;f/ ^ V. •/-"/ J_ ^AA 4ji(j f>V>» Cu— 4i\$£ <224. Af/f/ make not Allah's (Name) an excuse in your oaths against doing good and acting piously, and making peace among mankind. And AUdl is All-Hearer, All-Knower (i.e., do not sivear much and if you have sworn against doing something good then give an expiation for the oath and do good).} i225. Allah will not call you to account for that which is unintentional in your oaths, but He will call you to account for that which your hearts have earned. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most- Forbearing.} sS3'S di2-SCc il)'0^J»lsojs Oil \fS\j fffvj t| i3j j' j OJilsf *Ji(jjji-£5^ ' <uil «lli!ij)a rtiifjjJii-ju^p,o*jhbjX*iSteau'jJ <AJj 'A; -Uu^ ,a! *\$> OjilJa) 'J» O'QioUjijr-'_jo^ o^s » o_j^c-W-_> f'p 0_y^lju jjji- The Prohibition of swearing to abandon a Good Deed Allah commands, *You should not implement your vows in Allah's Name to refrain from pious acts and severing the relations with the relatives, if you swear to abandon such causes.' Allah said in another Ayah: < ii' jtM jl jjjt yi ij iyiljj iAnd let not those among you who are blessed with graces and

625 Surah 2. Al-Bagarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 wealth swear not to give (any sort of help) to their kinsmen, Al- Masakin (the poor), and those who left their homes for Allah's cause. Let them pardon and forgive. Do you not love that Allah should forgive you?} (24:22) Continuity in a sinful vow is more sinful than breaking it by expiation. Allah's Messenger sfe said: ^1 j* 4)1 Jiip aJ *LLi gfj jS) •aIIc Jill “By Allah! It is more sinful to Allah that one of you implements his vmv regarding (severing the relations with) his relatives than (breaking his promise and) paying the Kaffarah that Allah has required in such cases .» This is how Muslim reported this Hadith and also Imam Ahmad . ‘Ali bin Abu Talheih reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that what Allah said: ill' 'Jbof iAnd make not Allah's (Name) an excuse in your oaths} meems, “Do not vow to refrain from doing good works. (If you make such vow then) break it, pay the Kaffarah and do the good work.”¹³¹ This was also said by MasrQq, Ash-ShaTri, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Mujahid, Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ata’, ‘Ikrimah, Meikhul, Az-Zuhri, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, Ad-Deihhak, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani and As-Suddi . Suporting this view, which is the majority view, is what is reported in the Two Sahihs that Abu Musa Al-Ash‘ari narrated that Allah's Messenger jfe said: Sfl 1(1; V ii)l lli <jj iillj > j “By Allah! Allah willing, I zvill not vow to do a thing and then 111 Expiation, refer to 5 :89. ¹²¹ Fath Al-Bari 12:441, Muslim 3 :1276, Ahmad 2:317. At-Tabari 4 :422 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :700-702

626 Tafsir Itm Kathir see a better act, but 1 would do what is better and break my vow .ill1 ' Muslim reported that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah's Messenger 3g said: y> (i 'Ozk. Ik sQ* Tfa- jki Ik*- Ik" «Whoever makes a vow and then finds what is better than his vow (should break his vow,) pay the Kaffdrah and perform the better deedk2] TheLaghaw (Unintentional) Vows Allah said: -j 3 v> iAllah will not call you to account for that which is unintentional in your oaths,} This Ayah means, ‘Allah does not punish or hold you accountable for the Laghw (unintentional) vows that you make.’ The Laghw vows are unintentional and are just like the habitual statements that the tongue repeats, without really

intending them. For instance, it is reported in the Two Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: «Jil Vl V JJLi o'&L jil* - ^ Jlii «Wlwever swore and (unintentionally) mentioned Al-Lat and Al-'Uzza (two idols) in his vow, should then say, 'There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah' The Messenger ﷺ said this statement to some new Muslims whose tongues were, before Islam, used to vowing by their idol Al-Lat. Therefore, the Prophet ordered them to intentionally recite the slogan of Ikhlas, just as they mentioned these words by mistake, so that it (the word of Ikhlas) may eradicate the word (of Shirk). This is why Allah said: 111 Fath Al-Bari 11 :525, Muslim 3 :1268 Muslim 3:1272. ' Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :545 , Muslim 2 :1268

4...but He will call you to account for that which your hearts have earned. and in another Ayah: . . .for your deliberate oaths} (5:89) Abu Dawud reported under Chapter: The Laghw Vows' that 'Ata' said that 'A'ishah said that Allah's Messenger said: nilj ($\bullet^5^ y^* jcW^ i_j?$ Vililn «The Laghw in the voios includes what the man says in his house, such as, 'No, by Allah,' and, 'Yes, by Allah'. s' 11 Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Laghw vow includes vowing while angry. "12 He also reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Laghw vow includes vowing to prohibit what Allah has allowed, and this type does not require a Kaffarah (expiation)." Similar was said by Said bin JubayrJ31 In addition, Abu Dawud related under Chapter: "Vowing while Angry" that Said bin Musayyib said that two Ansari brothers both received inheritance and one of them asked that the inheritance be divided. His brother said, "If you ask me about dividing the inheritance again, then all of what I have will be spent on the Ka'bah's door." 'Umar said to him, "The Ka'bah does not need your money. So break your vow, pay the Kaffarah and come to terms with your brother. I heard Allah's Messenger ﷺ saying: «itU: aDo not make a vmo against yourself, nor to disobey the Lord, cut the relations ofthewomb or disposeofwhatyou do notown .»"141 Allah said: ti pTi*#. IM Abu Dawud 3:572. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 : 716. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:715. H Abu Dawud 3:581.

628 Tafsir ton Katlhr i.. but He will call you to account for that which your hearts nave earned,} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several others said that this Ayah metms swearing about a matter while knowing that he is lying. Mujahidand others said this Ayah is similar to what Allah said: 4.. but He will punish you for your deliberate oaths.} (5:89) Allah said (2:225 above): Wj} iAnd Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Forbearing .} meaning, He is Oft-Forgiving to His servants and Most Forbearing with them. bi 1 ,b m 3 oU^ iujl lAj rfctLS ^ S.bjj^ TTV jbit ijil 4226 . Those who take an oath not to have sexual relation with their wives must wait for four months, then if they return, veil /, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4222'. And if they decide upon divorce, then Allah is All- Hvater, All-Knoiver.} The ilVand its Rulings Ila ' is a type of vow where a man swears not to sleep with his wife for a certain period, whether less or more than four montns. If the vow of Ila' was for less than four months, the man has to wait for the vow's period to end and then is allowi d to have sexual intercourse with his wife. She has to be patient and she cannot ask her husband, in this case, to end his vcw before the end of its term. It is reported in the Two Sahih.r that 'A'ishah said that Allah's Messenger swore he would stay away from with his wives for a month. He then came down after twenty-nine days saying: 'Vj'-Z-tj ,4-^" «The (lunar) month is twenty-nine days ,» 1 ' 1 m Fath M-Bari 8 :380 , Muslim 2 :1 1 13.

629 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) Similar was narrated by Umar bin Al-Khattab and reported in the Two SahSis. If the period of Ila' is for more than four months, the wife is allowed in this case to

ask her husband, upon the end of the four months, to end the *hd'* and have sexual relations with her. Otherwise, he should divorce her, by being forced to do so by the authorities if necessary, so that the wife is not harmed. Allah said: *iThose who take an oath not to have sexual relations with their wives meaning, swear not to have sexual relations with the wife. This Ayah indicates that the M' involves the wife and not a slave-women, as the majority of the scholars have agreed, .must waitforfour months, meaning, the husband waits for four months from the time of the vow and then ends the lid' {if the vow was for four or more months) and is required to either return to his wife or divorce her. This is why Allah said next: 4 ...then if they return,} meaning, to a normal relationship, having sexual intercourse with the wife. This is the Tafsir of Ibn 'Abbas, Masruq, Ash- Shalii, Said bin Jubayr and Ibn Jarir.[2 4] ^& at Ifr 4...verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} with any shortcomings that occurred in the rights of the wife because of the vow of lla'. Allah said: Vyj. 4And if they decide upon divorce,} ,l ' Path Al-Ban 4 :143 , Muslim 2 At-Jabari 4:466,467.*

indicating that divorce does not occur by merely passing the four month mark (during the lla). Malik reported from Nafi' that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "If the man swears to Uol' from his wife, then divorce does not occur automatically even after the four months have passed. When he stops at the four months mark, he should either divorce or return."¹¹¹ Al- Bukhari also reported this HadlthP^ Ibn Jarir reported that Suhayl bin Abu Salih said that his father said, "I asked twelve Companions about the man who does Ha.' with his wife. They all stated that he does not have to do anything until the four months have passed and then has to either retain or divorce her."³ ' Ad-Daraqutni also reported this from Suhayl.¹⁴ It is also reported from 'Umar, 'Uthman, 'Ali, Abu Ad-Darda', 'A'ishah, Ibn 'Umar and Ibn 'Abbas. This is also the opinion of Said bin Musayyib, 'Umar bin 'Abdul-'AzIz, Mujahid, Tawus, Muhammad bin Ka'b and Al-Qasim. kittf *4 « *33 J\$U% tJj i."S^ <1*5 Irik ^rk <(228. And divorced women shall wait (as regards their marriage) for three menstrual periods, and it is not lawful for them to conceal wluit Allah has created in their wombs, if they believe in Allah and the Last Day. And their husbands have the better right to take them back in that period, if they wish for reconciliation. And they (women) have rights (over their husbands as regards living expenses) similar (to those of their husbands) over them (as regards obedience and respect) to what is reasonable, but men have a degree (of responsibility) over tlletn. And Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise The *Iddah (Waiting Period) ofthe DivorcedWoman This Ayah contains a command from Allah that the divorced woman, whose marriage was consummated and who still has 111 Al-Muwatta 2 :556 121 Fath Al-Bari9 :335 131 At-Tabari 4:493. '4 ' Ad-Daraqutni4 :61 .

631Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (22 - 252) (Part-2) menstruation periods, should wait for three (menstrual) periods (Quru after the divorce and then remarry if she wishes. The Meaning ofAl-Quru Ibn Jarir related that 'Alqamah said: We were with Umar bin Al-Khattab when a woman came and said, "My husband divorced me one or two periods ago. He then came back to me while I had prepared my water (for taking a bath], took off my clothes and closed my door." 'Umar asked 'Abdullah bin Mas*ud, "What do you think?" He said, "I think that she is still his wife, as long as she is not allowed to resume praying (i.e., until the third period ends before he takes her back)." 'Umar said, "This is my opinion too." This is also the opinion of Abu Bakr As-Siddlq, Umar, Uthman, 'Ali, Abu Ad-Darda', 'Ubadah bin As-Samit, Anas bin Malik, Ibn Mas"dd, Mu'adh, Ubayy bin Ka'b, Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari and Ibn 'Abbas. Furthermore, this is the opinion of Said bin Musayyib, 'Alqamah, Aswad, Ibrahim, Mujahid,

'Ata', Tawus, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Sirin, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ash-Shati, Ar-RabT, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi, Makhul, Ad-Dahhak and 'Ata' Al-Khurasani. They all stated that the Quru' is the menstruation period. What testifies to this is the Hadith that Abu Dawud and An-Nasal reported that Fatimah bint Abu Hubaiysh said that Allah's Messenger jg said to her: «Do not pray during your Aqrd' (pi. for Quru', the menstruation period). If this Hadith was authentic, it would have been a clear proof that the Quru' is the menstruation period. However, one of the narrators of this Hadith, Al-Mundhir, is an unknown person (in Hadith terminology), as Abu Hatim has stated, although Ibn Hibban has mentioned Al-Mundhir in his book Ath-Thiqat. At-Tabari 4:502. Abu Dawud 1 :191 , An-Nasa'i 6:21 1

633Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 husband is eligible to take his divorced wife back. We should mention that (when this Ayah 2:228 was revealed), the ruling that made the divorce thrice and specified when the husband is ineligible to take his divorced wife back, had not been revealed yet. Previously, the man used to divorce his wife and then take her back even if he had divorced her a hundred separate times. Thereafter, Allah revealed the following Ayah (2:229) that made the divorce only thrice. So there was now a reversible divorce and an irreversible final divorce. The Rights the Spouses have over Each Other Allah said: iAnd they (women) have rights (over their husbands as regards living expenses) similar (to those of their husbands) over them (as regards obedience and respect) to what is reasonable, This Ayah indicates that the wife has certain rights on her husband, just as he has certain rights on her, and each is obliged to give the other spouse his due rights. Muslim reported that Jabir said that Allah's Messenger said: tU J l 4)1 oliL L 4)1 I li .iiJS jji l Ajyb 3 f ut JgiP ^4)1 iFear Allah regarding your women, for you have taken them by Allah's covenant and were allowed to enjoy with them sexually by Allah's Words. You have the right on them that they do not allow anyone you dislike to sit on your mat. If they do that, then discipline them leniently. They have the right to be speitt on and to be bought clothes in what is reasonableV Bahz bin Hakim said that Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al- Qushayri related that his grandfather said, "O Messenger of Allah! What is the right the wife of one of us has?" The Prophet 5g said: i t v/j t IS) lit l^ *W* 0 111 Muslim 2 :886

J 'A+ "To feed her when you eat, buy her clothes when you buy for yourself and to refrain from striking her on the face, cursing her or staying awayfrom her except in the house .n*' 1 Waki' related that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I like to take care ofmy appearance for my wife just as I like for her to take care of her appearance for me. This is because Allah says: i*ISHt 4<&&¥ AAnd they (women) have rights similar (to those of their husbands) over them to what is reasonable.}" This statement is reported by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abu Hatim.12' The VirtueMen have overWomen Allah said: Irfo- Abut men have a degree (of responsibility) over them .} This Ayah indicates that men are in a more advantageous position than women physically as well as in their mannerism, status, obedience (of women to them), spending, taking care of the affairs and in general, in this life and in the Hereafter. Allah said (in another Ayah) -. AMen are the protectors and maintainers of women, because Allah has made one of them to excel the other, and because they spend (to support them)from their means.} (4:34) Allah's statement: AAnd Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise means, He is Mighty in His punishment of those who disobey Abu Dawud 2 :606. At-Jabari 4 :532, Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :750.

635 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) and defy His commands. He is Wise in what He commands, destines and legislates. 1, p. 19. 2. C-jj rS<Z Juu 'irt fi jli X wi'f •-« 'i >> * >• *' -* \ \g(. IfwJU aU' Jjfi*- AD* JJ-W U-Aj O 4229. The divorce is twice, after that either you retain her on reasonable terms or release her with kindness. And it is not lawful for you (men) to take back (from your wives) any of what you gave them (the Mahr, bridal-money given by the husband to his wife at the time of marriage), except when both parties fear that they would be unable to keep the limits ordained by Allah (e.g., to deal with each other on a fair basis). Then if you fear that they would not be able to keep the limits ordained by Allah, then there is no sin on either of them if she gives back (the Mahr or a part of it). These are the limits ordained by Allah, so do not transgress them. And whoever transgresses the limits ordained by Allah, then such are the wrongdoers> 4230. And if he has divorced her (the third time), then she is not lawful unto him thereafter until she has married another husband. Then, if the other husband divorces her, it is no sin on both of them that they reunite, provided they feel that they can keep the limits ordained by Allah. These are the limits of Allah, which He makes plain for the people who have knowledge. Divorce is Thrice This honorable Ayah abrogated the previous practice in the beginning of Islam, when the man had the right to take back his divorced wife even if he had divorced her a hundred times, as long as she was still in her 'Iddah (waiting period). This situation was harmful for the wife, and this is why Allah made the divorce thrice, where the husband is allowed to take back his wife after the first and the second divorce (as long as she is still in her 'Iddah). The divorce becomes irrevocable after the

third divorce, as Allah said: 4230 The divorce is twice, after that, either you retain her on reasonable terms or release her with kindness. In his Sunan, Abu Dawud reported in Chapter: "Taking the Wife back after the third (Divorce) is an abrogated practice," that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah. iAttd divorced women shall wait (as regards their marriage) for three menstrual periods, and it is not licenftl for them to conceal

The reason for the woman (who was divorced thrice) to marry another man must be that the man desires her and has the intention of having an extended married life with her. These are the legal goals and aims behind marriage. If the

reason behind the second marriage was to make the woman

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 642–647]

eligible for her ex-husband again, then this is the Tahiti that the Hadthhs have cursed and criticized. In addition, when the

reason behind this marriage (if it was Tahiti) is announced in the contract, it would make the contract invalid according to the majority of the scholars. Imam Ahmad reported that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "Allah's Messenger ﷺ cursed the one who does Tahiti, the one in whose favor it is done, those who eat RibA (usury) and those who feed it (pay the usury)."¹⁴¹ At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasat reported this Hadith^ and At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan." He said, "This is what is acted upon according to people of knowledge among the Companions, among whom are 111 Ahmad 6:34 121 Fath Al-Bari 10 :

518, Muslim 2 :1057, An-Nasal 6 :146. 131 Ahmad 6 :62 141 Ahmad 1:448. Ahmad 1 :448 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi4 :268 , An-Nasal 6 :149

‘Umar, ‘Uthman and Ibn ‘Umar. It was also the saying of the scholars of Fiqh among the Tabi’in (second generation of Islam). And it has been reported from ‘Ali, Ibn Mas‘ud and Ibn ‘Abbas”. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim reported that Nafi‘ said: “A man came to Ibn ‘Umar and asked him about a man who divorced his wife three times. Then, his brother married her to make Tahiti for his brother, without the brother knowing this fact. He then asked, “Is she allowed for the first (husband)?” He said, “No, unless it is a marriage that involves desire. We used to consider this an act of adultery during the time of Allah’s Messenger sg.” Al-Hakim said, “This Hadith has a Sahth chain although they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it.” The wording of this Hadith indicates that the ruling came from the Prophet Abu Bakr bin Abu Shaybah, Al-Jawzjani, Harb Al- Kirmani and Abu Bakr Al-Athram said that Qablsah bin Jabir said that ‘Umar said, “If the participants to Tahiti are brought to me, I will have them stoned. | 2 ’ When does a Woman who was divorced Three Times become Eligible for Her First Husband Allah said: iAnd if he has divorced her> meaning, the second husband after he had complete sexual relations with her, iit is no siti on both of them that they reunite^ meaning, the wife and her first husband, 4^ JJ-W- l.-ai ol iprovided they feel that they can keep the limits ordained by Allah. meaning, they live together honorably. Mujahid said, “If they are convinced that the aim behind their marriage is honorable. ' Next, Allah said: jjii- 1,1 Al-Hakim 2:199. I2 * Ibn Abi Shaybah 4 :294 131 At-Tabari 4:598.

644 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ~mibi w mm jl JC~iU cA?>^~4J Ji*ubb‘f<J*r'-s^ JJ^Ju^cAjfZr VjJAMitoilslj Jus dJJ'i J>^ i>V>b' (J-SijJj^U*^4'-j J4^'->^ CiySa^ L? Udj's'Jo^ O^jl.Ac.V34i'ijiJ^'-3-l^-V ^ iTiiese are the limits of Allah,} His commandments and legislation, (He makes plain fs& ifor the people who have knowledge.} 1&\ j& i£\$ “f&> \if} ter *w &&& 6fe SJs4 % jjli» JUS ilM'i <yj l)Xo!j Vjyt <5il o£ll tjJjii *!?!j illi \$% £3 li'ifj *&*\$ S5 ££ 3 'A i>% i £IS «#£* »\$& ^231. And when you have divorced women and they have fulfilled the term of their prescribed period, either take them back on a reasonable basis or set them free on a reasonable basis. But do not take them back to hurt them, and whoever does that, then he has wronged himself. And treat not the verses (Laws) of Allah in jest, but remember Allah's favors on you (i.e., Islam), and that which He has sent down to you of the Book (i.e., the Qur'an) and Al-Hikmah (the Prophet's Sunnah - legal ways - Islamic jurisprudence) whereby He instructs you . And fear Allah, and know that Allah is All-Aware ofeverything}. BeingKind to the Divorced Wife This is a command from Allah to men that when one of them divorces his wife with a reversible divorce, he should

645Surah 2. Al-Baoarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) treat her kindly. So when her term of ‘Iddah (waiting period) nears its end, he either takes her back in a way that is better, including having witnesses that he has taken her back, and he lives with her with kindness. Or, he should release her after her ‘Iddah finishes and then kindly asks her to depart from his house, without disputing, fighting with her or using foul words. Allah then said: iVx2 \$But do not take them back to hurt them,} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Masruq, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak, Ar-Rabl‘ and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that a man used to divorce his wife, and when her ‘Iddah came near its end, he would take her back to harm her and to stop her from marrying someone else. He then divorced her and she would begin her ‘Iddah and when her

'Iddah term neared its end, he would take her back again, so that the term of 'Iddah would be prolonged for her. After that, Allah prohibited this practice. ' Allah has also threatened those who indulge in such practices, when He said; *ii jXb Jd* idS'i* and whoever does that, then he has wronged himself.} meaning, by defying Allah's commandments. Allah then said: *iAnd treat not the verses (Laws) of Allah in a jest,*} Ibn Jarir said that Abu Musa (Al-Ash'ari) narrated that Allah's Messenger *ig* once became angry at the Ash'ari tribe. Abu Musa went to him and said, "O Messenger of Allah! Are you angry with the Ash'ariyyin?" The Prophet *ig* said: "One of you says, 'I divorced her' -then says- 'I took her back!' This is not the appropriate way Muslims conduct divorce. 1,1 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:772-774.

647 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (22 - 252) (Part-2) none of your secret or public affairs ever escapes His knowledge, and He will treat you accordingly. *>'n j&&* & m pi Sf Ayfij^ ^ • *» JI*j» illl'i 4>tt ; c>Jjl* <232. And when you have divorced women and they have fulfilled the term of their prescribed period, do not prevent them from marrying their (former) husbands, if they mutually agree on reasonable basis. This (instruction) is an admonition for him among you who believes in Allah and the Last Day. That is more virtuous and purer for you. Allah knows and you know not.} The Wall (Guardian) of the Divorced Woman should not prevent Her from going back to Her Husband 'Ali bin Abu Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This Ayah was revealed about the man who divorces his wife once or twice and her 'Iddah finishes. He later thinks about taking her back in marriage and the woman also wishes that, yet, her family prevents her from remarrying him. Hence, Allah prohibited her family from preventing her." Masruq, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, Az-Zuhri and Ad-Dahhak stated that this is the

the meaning of Allah's statement:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 663–669]

-iy \)JS o' i . . . except that you speak an honorable saying.} He said, "He says to her Wali, 'Do not give her away (in marriage) until you inform me first'." This statement was narrated by Ibn Abu Hatim.'3 Allah then said: *kAac. A* And do not be determined on the marriage bond until the term prescribed is fulfilled.> meaning, do not make marriage contracts before the 'Iddah finishes. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ash-Shaln, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Abu Malik, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Az-Zuhri, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi, Ath-Thawri and Ad- Dahhak said that: *iuntil the term prescribed is fulfilled.*} means, 'Do not consummate the marriage before the 'Iddah term finishes.'*4 * The scholars agree that marriage contracts during the 'Iddah are invalid. Allah then said: *iUxk -4 u pz& A* And know that Allah knows what is in your minds, so fear Him.} warning the men against the ideas they conceal in their hearts about women, directing them to think good about them rather 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:824. * At-Tabari 5:114. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :826. [4 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :828,829

4~J. jjUli \Ej 4a\ 4237 . And if you divorce them before you have touched (had a sexual relation with) them, and you have appointed for them their due (dowry), then pay half of that, unless they (the women) agree to remit it, or he (the husband), in whose hands is the marriage tie, agrees to remit it. And to remit is nearer to At-Taqwa (piety, righteousness). And do not forget liberality between yourselves . Truly, Allah is All-Seer of what you do.} The Wife gets half of Her Mahr if She is divorced before the Marriage is consummated This honorable Ayah is not a continuation of the Mut'ah (gift) that was mentioned in the previous Ayah (i.e., divorce before the marriage is consummated). This Ayah (2:237)

requires the husband to relinquish half of the appointed Mahr if he divorces his wife before the marriage is consummated. If it was discussing any other type of gift, then it would have been mentioned that way, especially when this Ayah follows the previous Ayah related to this subject. Allah knows best. Giving away half of the bridal-money in this case is the agreed practice according to the scholars. So, the husband pays half of the appointed Mahr if he divorces his wife before consummating the marriage. Allah then said: 4unless they (the women) agree to remit it,} meaning, the wife forfeits the dowry and relieves the husband from further financial responsibility. As-Suddi said that Abu Salih mentioned that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement: J%} iunless they (the women) agree to remit it,} "Unless the wife forfeits her right."11 ' Furthermore, Imam Abu 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :839

Muhammad bin Abu Hatim said that it was reported that Shurayh, Said bin Musayyib, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ash-ShaTsi, Al-Hasan, Nafi', Qatadah, Jabir bin Zayd, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ibn Sinn, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and As-Suddi said similarly.* 11 Allah then said: fy i...or he (the husband), in whose hands is the marriage tie, agrees to remit it.) Ibn Abu Hatim reported that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb said that his grandfather narrated that the Prophet sg said: siie- *The husband is he wlw has the marriage he.»121 Ibn Marduwyah also reported this Hadith, and it is the view chosen by Ibn Jarir. The Hadith states that the husband is the person who really holds the marriage tie in his hand, as it is up to him to go on with the marriage or end it. On the other hand, the Wali of the wife is not allowed to give away any of her rightful dues without her permission, especially the dowry. Allah then stated: 1 -4-i^)And to remit it is nearer to At-Taquwa (piety, righteousness).) Ibn Jarir said, "Some scholars said that this statement is directed atbothmenandwomen." Ibn 'Abbas stud: iAnd to remit it is nearer to At-Taquw (piety, righteousness).) indicates that the one who forgives, is nearer to At-Taquwa (piety)."*31 A similar statement was made by Ash-Sha*bi and several other scholars. Mujahid, An-Nakha'i, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar- 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :840-842 *21 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :842 131 At-Jabari 5:162.

Rabl' bin Anas and Thawri stated that 'liberality' mentioned in the Ayah refers to the woman giving away her half Mahr, or the man giving away the full Afahr. This is why Allah said here: & ipi 1;} iAnd do not forget liberality between yourselves.} meaning, kindness (or generosity), as Said has stated. 121 Allah said: iTruly, Allah is All- Seer of what you do.} meaning, none of your affairs ever escapes His perfect Watch, and He will reward each according to his deeds. v rn'vA ** mm ^ 4JJ y*fiy \ J ^Aiijltpi==d jC-AAij ?f|} jSL^sat jJ-U! £«*} sf} JaJS Jajialj9 , wa-ii 0jtf==> 4 'jijSo li t3r «jji Tj^S 4238. Guard strictly (five obligatory) As-Salawdt (the prayers) especially the Middle Salah. And stand before Allah with obedience.} 4239. And ifyou fear (an enemy), (perform Salah) on foot or riding. And when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray) in the manner He has taught you, which you kneio not m At-Tabari 5:165,166. 121 At-Tabari 5:166.

(before).} Allah commands that the prayer should be performed properly and on time. It is reported in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas'Qd said, "I asked the Prophet j^, 'Which deed is the dearest (to Allah)?' He replied: *To offer the prayers at theirfixed times. I asked, What is the next (in goodness)?' He replied: Mil Jr-J *To participate in Jihad (religions fighting) in Allah's cause.*" I again asked, What is the next (in goodness)?' He replied: •oiJJ y «To be good and dutiful to your parents .» 'Abdullah then added, "The Prophet ^ told me these words, and had I asked more, the Prophet jfe would have told me

more.”¹¹¹ The Middle Prayer Furthermore, Allah has specifically mentioned the Middle prayer, which is the ‘Asr prayer according to the majority of the scholars among the Companions, as At-Tirmidhi and Al-Baghawi have stated. Al-Qadi Al-Mawardi added that the majority of the scholars of the Tabi’in also held this view. Al-Hafiz Abu TJmar bin ‘Abdul-Barr said that this is also the opinion of the majority of the scholars of the Athar (i.e., the Hadith and the statements of the Salaf). In addition, Abu Muhammad bin ‘Atiyah said that this is the Tafsir (of the Middle prayer) of the majority of scholars. Al-Hafiz Abu Muhammad ‘Abdul-Mu’min bin Khalaf Ad-Dumyati stated in his book on the Middle prayer that it is the ‘Asr prayer and mentioned that this is the Tafsir of ‘Umar, ‘Ali, Ibn Mas‘ud, Abu Ayyub, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr, Samurah bin Jundub, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Said, Hafsah, Umm Habibah, Umm Salamah, Ibn ‘Abbas and ‘A’ishah. This is also the Tafsir of TJbaydah, 111 Fath Al-BOri2:12, MusUm 1 :90

sank1mBwr«hJ225 - 252) (Part21 MuqSl, Ubayd bin Abu Maiyam, and others. The Proofthat the ‘AsrPrayer is the Middle Prayer Confederates): _ , ,, ,yi^ *i*.*>*.*> iW«y .Ttev (fc disbelievers} ImsM us from'performing pr^r.the ‘Mr prayer, may AM. fill Iherr hearts and houses with fire » (He performed the ‘Asr prayer between Maghrib and /sha Muslta and An-Nasal recorded this HadUh In adUU, Two Shaykhs, Abu Dawud, At-Trmudhi An-Nasal ana several other collector, of the SUMrn recorder‘ 'hrs^Ut using different chains of narrators to All. Allah’s

the battle of Al-Ahzdb, when the Mushnks prevented Mlah s

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 669–671]

Messenger sg and his Companions from performing the A prayer has been narrated by several other Companions We only mentioned the narrations that stated that the Middle prayer is the -Asr prayer. Furthermore, wordings for this HadUh from Ibn Mas‘ud and Al-Bara bin ‘Azib In addition, Imam Ahmad reported that Samurah bin Jundub said that Allah’s Messenger£ said: iThe Middle prayer is the 'Asr prayer. l5] In another narration, Allah’s Messenger\$ mentioned: hi Ahmad 1:113. PI Muslim 1 : 437 , An-Nasal 6 :303 ' Muslim 1 :437 ,438 l5I Ahmad 5 :22

lafsir Ibn Kathir fc“MdM^LTlnitS fta/lfTfthf ^l.f% another Mn-ation, Allah's Messenger«Ud: ^ prayer" to “// is the 'Asr prayerj “al^^TCrp“ M T^»h WaS th"" b**”S SS»?=afesSSaS OjJiiJl S^U> Ja^jl iii! “The Middle prayer is the 'Asr prayer »(4i MtlLTs” that Ibn MasM“»« «« Allah's V^ 1 i^Lc “The 'Asr prayer is the Middle prayer . tv^eS rm Mu“, the '1 statet* tha‘ 'his Hadlth is of a IJasan, Sahih wordings are to Ws “* his p^rttr;,ts? “s^ «*” M« rp^rttrr ^r^ (^s f,, the authentic Hachth, Allah's Messenger j# emphasized the aTrLsr^ the^^^” z ,lJ Ahmad 5:8. * Atimad 5 :7 i4 i TuWat Al-Ah.wad.hi 8 :328 Ibn Hibban 3 :12 1 Tu^fatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :329 Muslim 1 :437.

JUf yj UjtSo yjl*}\ o^iLi Alj li «Whoever misses the 'Asr prayer will be like who has lost his family and money .» [1 ' It is reported in the Sahih that Buraydah bin Al-Husayb said that the Prophet said: “On a cloudy day, perform the (‘Asr) prayer early, for whoever misses the 'Asr prayer, will have his (good) deeds annulled .»*21

The Prohibition of speaking during the Prayer

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 671–682]

Allah said: And stand before Allah with obedience. meaning, with humbleness and humility before Him (i.e., during the prayer). This command indicates that it is not allowed to speak during the prayer, as speaking contradicts the nature of the prayer. This is why the Prophet ﷺ refused to answer Ibn Mas'ud when he greeted him while he was praying and said afterwards: «The prayer makes one sufficiently f?st/»³¹ (i.e., by the various actions of the body, tongue and heart involved during the prayer.) Muslim reported that the Prophet said to Mu'awiyah bin Hakam As-Sulami when he spoke during the prayer: Err-~^ i tfj 'j t^Lkl ejtft oj «jiil 'jSij “The ordinary speech people indulge in is not appropriate during the prayer. The prayer involves only Tasbih (praising Allah), Takbir (saying Alldhu Akbar, i.e., Allah is the Most Muslim 1 :436. 121 Ibn Majah 1 :224 Muslim 1 :382

Great) and remembering Allah. Imam Ahmad reported that Zayd bin Arqam said, “One used to address his friend about various affairs during the prayer. Then when this Ayah was revealed: k\ iAnd stand before Allah with obedience.} we were ordered to refrain from speaking.”^{12*} The Group*³ (i.e., the Hadith collections), except Ibn Majah, reported this Hadith. The Fear Prayer Allah said: 0j>- o' iAnd ifyou fear (an enemy), (perform Saldh) on foot or riding. And when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray) in the manner He has taught you, which you knew not (before).} After Allah commanded His servants to perform the prayer perfectly and emphasized this commandment. He mentioned the situation where the person might not be able to perform the prayer perfectly, during battle and combat. Allah said: iAnd ifyou fear (an enemy), perform Saldh on foot or riding.} meaning, pray in the appropriate manner under these circumstances, whether on foot or riding and whether facing the Qiblah or otherwise. Imam Malik reported that Nafi' related that Ibn TJmar used to describe the Fear prayer when he was asked about it and would then add, “If there is intense fear, pray on foot, riding, facing the Qiblah and otherwise.” Nafi' commented, “I think that he related that to the Prophet #,.”⁴ 111 Muslim 1:381. * Ahmad 4:368. * Fath Al-Bari 3:88, Muslilm 1 :383, Abu Dawud 1 :583, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi8 : 330 , An-Nasal 3:18. * Al-Muwatta' 1:184.

673Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (223 - 252) (Part-2) Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported the HadithP^ Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasal, ibn Majah and Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, “Allah has ordained the prayer by the words of your Prophet four (Rak'ah) while residing, two oh while traveling and one Rak'ah during times of fear.”¹ This is also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, and others . In addition, Al-Bukhari has entitled a Chapter: ‘Prayer while confronting the Forts and facing the Enemy’. Al-Awzal said, “If the victory seems near and the Muslims are unable to perform the prayer (in the normal manner), they should pray by nodding each by himself. If they are unable to nod, they should delay the prayer until fighting is finished. When they feel safe, they should pray two Rak'ah. If they are unable, they should then pray one Rak'ah that includes two prostrations. If they are unable, then Takbir alone does not suffice, so they should delay the prayer until they are safe.” This is the same view that Makhul held. Anas bin Malik said, “I participated in the attack on the fort of Tatar, when the light of dawn started to become clear. Suddenly, the fighting raged and the Muslims were unable to pray until the fight of day spread. We then prayed (the Dawn prayer) with Abu MUsa and we became victorious. I would not have been pleased if I were to gain in the life of this world and whatever is in it instead of that prayer.”¹ This is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Prayer during the Times of Peace is performed normally Allah said: iArui when you are in safety, then remember Allah (pray)) meaning, ‘Perform the prayer as I have commanded you by completing its bowing, prostration, standing, sitting,

and with the required attention (in the heart) and supplication.’ Allah said: Fath Al-Bari 8 :46 , Muslim 1 :574 Muslim 1 :478,479 , Abu Dawud 2:40, An-Nasal 3:169, Ibn Maiah 1 :339, At-Tabari 5: 247. At-Tabari 5 :240,241 Fath Al-Bari 2:503.

tiP \$ tf £2} iin the manner He has taught you, which you knew not (before). meaning, just as He has endowed you, guided you and taught you about what benefits you in this life and the Hereafter, so thank and remember Him. Similarly, Allah said after He mentioned the prayer of Fear, i6& (IT s&p£& v&\ ijfcrf f# 4...but when you are free from danger, perform As-Saldh. Verily, As-Saldh (the prayer) is enjoined on the believers at fixed hours.) (4:103) We will mention the Hadiths about the prayer of Fear and its description in Surat An-Nisa’ while mentioning Allah’s statement: iWhen you (O Messenger Muliammad sg) are among them, and lead them in As-Saldh (the prayer).} (4:102) J JI *Pj ‘it&’jfo afj ‘jxr” Of £ 4 \$ i)V iif ^JQ’SST j* ^ 4.w* j*lii ‘i 4240. And those ofyou who die and leave behind wives should bequeath for their wives a year’s maintenance (and residence) without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves, provided it is honorable (e.g., lawful marriage). And Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.} 4242. And for divorced women, maintenance (should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious).} 4242. Thus Allah makes clear His Aydt (Laws) to you, in order that you may understand>

Ayah (2:240) was abrogated The majority of the scholars said that this Ayah (2:240) was abrogated by the Ayah (2:234), what Allah said: 4 . . .they (the ivives) shall wait (as regards their marriage) far four months and ten days.) (2:234) For instance, Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn Az-Zubayr said: I said to TJthman bin ‘Affan: jjjyy iAnd those ofyou who die and leave wives behind them) was abrogated by the other Ayah (2:234). Therefore, why did you collect it (meaning, in the Qur’an)?” He said, “O mynephew! I shall not change any part of the Qur’an from its place.” The question that Ibn Az-Zubayr asked TJthman means: If the ruling of the Ayah (2:240) was abrogated to four months (the 'Iddah of the widow, and refer to 2:234), then what is the wisdom behind including it in the Qur’an, although its ruling has been abrogated? If the Ayah (2:240) remains (in the Qur’an) after the Ayah that abrogated it (2:234), this mightimply that its ruling is still valid.’ TJthman, the Leader of the faithful, answered him by stating that this is a matter of the revelation, which mentioned these Ayat in this order. Therefore, I shall leave the Ayah where I found it in the Qur’an.’ Ibn Abu Hatim reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said about what Allah said: iAnd those of you who die and leave behind wives should bequeath far their wives a year's maintenance (and residence) without turning them out,) “The widow used to reside, and have her provisions provided m Fath Al-Bari 8:48.

used to be the ‘Iddah, and the widow had to remain with her (deceased) husband’s family (during that period, i.e., four months and ten days). Then, Allah revealed: I*!-’-’”! -£ 4And those of you who die and leave behind wives should bequeath for their wives a year's maintenance (and residence) without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves, provided it is honorable (e.g., lawful marriage). So, Allah made the rest of the year, which is seven months and twenty days, as a will and testament for her. Consequently, if she wants, she could use her right in this will and remain in the residence (for the rest of the year). Or, if she wants, she could leave the (deceased husband’s) house after the four months and ten days have passed. This is the meaning ofwhat Allah said: i...without turning them out, but if they (wives) leave, there is no sin on you.}

Therefore, the required term of 'Iddah is still unchanged (refer to 2:234). 'Ata' quoted Ibn 'Abbas, "This Ayah (2:240) has abrogated (the requirement that) the widow spends the 'Iddah with his (i.e., her deceased husband's) family. So, she spends her 'Iddah wherever she wants. This is the meaning of what Allah said: 4^4 iwithout turning them out,}." 'Ata' also said: "If she wants, she spends the 'Iddah with his family and resides there according to the will (meaning the rest of the year). If she wants, she is allowed to leave, for Allah said: LLj ithere is no sin on you for that which they do of themselves,}."

'Ata' then said: "Then (the Ayah on) the inheritance (refer to 4:12) came and abrogated the residence. Hence, the widow spends her 'Iddah wherever she wants and does not have the right to residence any more." The statement of 'Ata' and those who held the view that the Ayah (2:240) was abrogated by the Ayah on the inheritance (4:12), is only valid for more than the four months and ten days (required in 2:234). However, if they mean that the four months and ten days are not required from the deceased husband's estate, then this opinion is the subject of disagreement among the scholars. As proof, they said that the widow is required to remain in her (deceased) husband's house (for four months and ten days) according to what Malik reported from Zaynab bint Ka*b bin TJjah. She said that Fari'ah bint Malik bin Sinan, the sister of Abu Said Al-Khudri, told her that she came to Allah's Messenger^ asking him to return to her family's residence with Banu Khudrah. Her husband had pursued some of his servants who ran away, but when he reached the area of Al-Qadum, they killed him. She said, "So I asked Allah's Messenger jg if I should stay with my family in Banu Khudrah, for my (deceased) husband did not leave me a residence that he owns or Nafaqah (maintenance). Allah's Messenger jg answered in the positive. While I was in the room, Allah's Messenger jg summoned me or had someone summon me and said: ., , zWIat did you say? I repeated the story to him about my (deceased) husband. He said: «ijjA 4.GS3I^ JU 4^J "Stay at your home until the term reaches its end. So I remained through the 'Iddah term for four months and ten days in my (deceased husband's) house. Thereafter, Uthman bin 'Allan sent for me during his reign and asked me about this matter and I told him what happened. He made a judgment to the same effect. "21 This Hadlth was also collected 111 Al-Bukhari 4531,5344. 121 Al-Muwatta' 2:591.

679 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.m At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih". TheNecessityoftheMut'ah (Gift) attheTime ofDivorce Allah said: iAndfor divorced women, maintenance (should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious) .} 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that when Allah's statement: i...a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers ofgood} (2:236) was revealed, a man said, "If I want, I will be excellent and if I do not, I will not." Thereafter, Allah revealed this Ayah: iAndfor divorced women, maintenance (should be provided) on reasonable (scale). This is a duty on Al-Muttaqin (the pious). The scholars who ruled that the Mut'ah (reasonable gift) at the time of divorce is required for eveiy divorced woman, whether she had a bridal-money appointed for her or not, and whether the marriage was consummated or not, relied on this Ayah (2:241) when they issued their ruling. This is the view taken on this subject by Said bin Jubayr and several others among the Salaf*31 and also Ibn Jarir. Hence, Allah's statement: Jr o+i j' o*4^ \$ & -Zjf uj. ^ sAt jc-j »jJi iThere is no sin on you, if you divorce women while yet you have not touched (had sexual relation with) them, nor appointed Abu Dawud 2:773, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:319,390, An-Nasal 6:200, Ibn Majah 1 :654. At-Tabari 5 :264. At-Tabari 5:263.

680 Tafstr Ibn Kathir for than their due (dowry) . But bestow on them (a suitable gift), the rich according to his means, and the poor according to his means, a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers of good.) (2:236) only mentions some specifics of this general ruling. Allah then said: 4**~j'* ii(^ iThus Allah makes clear His Ayat (Laws) to you,) meaning, what He allows, forbids, requires, His set limits, His commandments and His prohibitions are all explained and made plain and clear for you. He did not leave any matter in general terms if you needed the specifics, iin order that you may understand.) meaning, understand and comprehend. P iyji if .H? Jffii J4 Oi !&s; f; v UJm jsn ^^ if Jaju ifif \> if of l[£kfj & 4 jS^iu iifj 4^0 jfj ,*i 4243. Did you (O Muhammad jg) not think of those who went forth from their homes in the thousands, fearing death? Allah said to them, "Die". And that He restored them to life. Truly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind, but most men thank not.) 4244. And fight in the way of Allah and know that Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.) 4245. Who is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan so that He may multiply it to him many times? And it is Allah that decreases or increases (your provisions), and unto Him you shall return.) The Stoij of the Dead People Ibn Abu Hatdm related that Ibn 'Abbas said that these people mentioned herein, were the residents of a village called Dawardan. 'Ali bin 'Asim said that they were from Dawardan,

681 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) a village several miles away from Wasit (in Iraq). In his Tafsir, Waki' bin Jarrah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented. iDid you (O Muhammad not think of those who went forth from their homes in thousands, fearing death?) that they were four thousand persons who escaped the plague (that broke out in their land). They said, "We should go to a land that is free of death!" When they reached a certain area, Allah said to them: i'Ve."} and they all died. Afterwards, one of the Prophets passed by them and supplicated to Allah to resurrect them and Allah brought them back to life. So, Allah stated: 4y>pi' Ojli L/& j) J-« f&} iDid you (O Muhammad not think of those who went forth from their homes in the thousands, fearing death?) Furthermore, several scholars among the Salaf said that these people were the residents of a city during the time of the Children of Israel. The weather in their land did not suit them and an epidemic broke out. They fled their land fearing death and took refuge in the wilderness. They later arrived at a fertile valley and they filled what is between its two sides. Then Allah sent two angels to them, one from the lower side and the other from the upper side of the valley. The angels screamed once and all the people died instantly, just as the death of one man. They were later moved to a different place, where walls and graves were built around them. They all perished, and their bodies rotted and disintegrated. Long afterwards, one of the Prophets of the Children of Israel, whose name was Hizql (Ezekiel), passed by them and asked Allah to bring them back to life by his hand. Allah accepted his supplication and commanded him to say, "O rotted bones, Allah commands you to come together." The bones of every body were brought together. Allah then commanded him to

682 Tafstr Ibn Kathir say, "O bones, Allah commands you to be covered with flesh, nerves and skin." That also happened while Hizql was watching. Allah then commanded him to say, "O souls, Allah commands you to return, each to the body that it used to inhabit." They all came back to life, looked around and proclaimed, "All praise is due to You (O Allah!) and there is no deity worthy of worship except You." Allah brought them back to life after they had perished long ago. We should state that bringing these people back to life is a clear proof that physical resurrection shall occur on the Day of Resurrection. This is why Allah said: iTruly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind,} meaning, in that He

shows them His great signs, sound proofs and clear evidences. Yet, 'j UJ ibut most men thank not.}ll] as they do not thank Allah for what He has given them with in their worldly life and religious affairs.

The Story of the Jews Who sought a King to be

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 686–703]

appointed over Them Mujahid said that the Prophet (mentioned in the Ayah 2:246 above) is Shamwil (Samuel). ' Wahb bin Munabbih said: The Children of Israel remained on the straight path for a period of time after Moses. They then innovated in the religion and some of them even worshipped the idols. Yet, there were always Prophets sent among them who would command them to work righteous deeds, refrain from doing evil and who would rule them according to the commands of the Torah. When they (Israelites) committed the evil that they committed, Allah caused their enemies to overwhelm them, and many fatalities fell among them as a consequence. Their enemies also captured a great number of them, and took over large areas of their land. Earlier, anyone who would fight the Israelites would lose, because they had the Torah and the Tdhiit,'2 ' which they inherited generation after generation ever since the time of Moses, who spoke to Allah directly. Yet, the Israelites kept indulging in misguidance until some king took the Tabut from them during a battle. That king also took possession of the Torah, and only a few of the Israelites who memorized it remained. The prophethood halted among their various tribes and only a pregnant woman remained of the offspring of Lavi (Levi), in whom the prophethood still appeared. Her husband had been killed, so the Israelites kept her in a house so that Allah may give her a boy, who would be their Prophet. The woman also kept invoking Allah to grant her a boy. Allah heard her pleas and gave her a boy whom she At-Tabari 5:293. 'The ark of the Covenant.'

687 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) called 'Shamwil' meaning 'Allah has heard my pleas.' Some people said that the boy's name was Sham'un (Simeon), which also has a similar meaning. As that boy grew, Allah raised him to be a righteous person. When he reached the age of prophethood, Allah revealed to him and commanded him to call (his people) to Him and to His TawhicL (Oneness). Shamwll called the Children of Israel (to Allah) and they asked him to appoint a king over them so that they could fight their enemies under his command. The kingship had also ended among them. Their Prophet said to them, "What if Allah appoints a king over you, would you fulfill your vow to fight under his command?" irr - :•* SA r- 4They said, "Why should we not fight in Allah's way while toe have been driven out of our homes and our children?"} meaning, 'After our land had been confiscated and our children had been taken from us?' Allah said: li ^ ±41 Ij & 44C4 4But when fighting was ordered for them, they turned away, all except a few of them. And Allah is All-Aware of the wrongdoers meaning, only a few of them kept their promise, but the majority abandoned Jihad and Allah has full knowledge of them. C~>> jj ill! oj .r JUj^ ix&j & Si Ju aai 4 it, d&l >1% ii14 (~y'j - i j* jj) Ji'j 44 4 «'jj ^ ny ;7—44 i247. And their Prophet said to them, "Indeed Allah has appointed Taliit (Saul) as a king over you." They said, "How can he be a king over us when we are fitter than him for the kingdom, and he has not been given enough wealth." He said: "Verily , Allah has chosen him above you and has increased him abundantly in knowledge and stature. And Allah grants His kingdom to whom He wills. And Allah is All-Sufficient for His

creatures' needs, All-Knower.”) When the Israelites asked their Prophet to appoint a king over them, he appointed Talut (Saul), who was then a soldier. But, Talut was not a descendant of the house of kings among them, which was exclusively in the offspring of Yahudha (Judah). This is why they said: «££ JiJ'i i) 3\$ iHow can he be a king over us) meaning, how can he be the king for us. iwhen we are fitter than him for the kingdom, and he has not been given enough wealth?) They said that Talut was also poor and did not have the wealth that justifies him being king. Some people stated that Talut used to bring water to the people, while others stated that his profession was dyeing skins. The Jews, thus, disputed with their Prophet while they were supposed to obey him and to say good words to him. Their Prophet answered them: C. 4jll 0^ iVerily, Allah has chosen him above you) meaning, ‘Allah chose Talut from amongst you while having better knowledge about him.’ Their Prophet stated, “I did not choose Talut to be your king on my own. Rather, Allah has commanded that upon your request.” Further: 44—' 4—«)' 4 * la*4 i...and has increased him abundantly in knowledge and stature.) meaning, Talut is more knowledgeable and honorable than you, and stronger and more patient during combat, and has more knowledge of warfare. In short, he has more knowledge and is stronger than you are. The king should have sufficient knowledge, be fair looking and should have a strong soul and body.’ He then said: 4*^2 \$j) \$And Allah grants His kingdom to whom He wills.)

689 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2 meaning, Allah Alone is the Supreme Authority Who does what He wills and no one can ask Him about His actions, while they will be asked (about their actions by Him). This is because Allah has perfect knowledge, wisdom and kindness with His creation. Allah said: }And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower.} meaning, His favor is encompassing and He grants His mercy to whom He wills. He also knows those who deserve to be kings and those who do not deserve it. Am A ^^^ 1U •^4'i j i>lo). Jll CLj ilijj fj==uj / < V i < / _ 4248 . And their Prophet said to them: "Verily! Tire sign of His kingdom is that there shall come to you At-Tabfit, wherein is Sakinah (peace and reassurance) from your Lord and a remnant of that which Musa (Moses) and Harun (Aaron) left behind, carried by the angels. Verily, in this is a sign for you if you are indeed believers.} Their Prophet then proclaimed, “The sign of the blessings of Talut’s kingship over you is that Allah will give you back the Tabut (wooden box) that has been taken from you.” Allah said: iwhereiti is Sakinah from your Lord meaning, peace (or grace) and reassurance. ‘Abdur-Razzaq stated that Qatadah said: iwherein is Sakinah means grace.* ’* In addition, Ar-Rabl‘ said that Sakinah means mercy. This is also the meaning given by Ibn ‘Abbas, as Al- ‘Awfi narrated. *** ‘Abdur-Razzaq 1:98.

690 Tafislr Ibn Kathir Allah then said: jttj i...and a remnant of that which Musa (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Ibn Jarir related that Ibn ‘Abbas said about this Ayah: Jl» U-j i...and a remnant of that which Miisd (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Meaning, Moses’ staff and the remnants of the Tablets. * This is the same Tafsir of Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ar-RabT bin Anas and Tkrimah, who added, “And also the Torah.”121 ‘Abdur- Razzaq said that he asked Ath-Thawri about the meaning of, i...and a remnant of that which Miisd (Moses) and Hdrun (Aaron) left behind,} Ath-Thawri said, “Some said that it contained a pot of manna and the remnants of the Tablets, while some others said that it contained (Moses’) staff and two shoes (and refer to 20 : 12).”31 Allah then said: «LJ-} i...carried by the angels.} Ibn Jurayj stated that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The angels came down while carrying the Tabut between the sky and the earth, until they placed it before Talut while the people were watching.” As-Suddi said, “The Tabut was brought to TalQt’s house, so the people believed in the prophethood of

ShamTin (Simeon) and obeyed Talut” The Prophet then said: At-Tabari 5:331. At-Tabari 5:331,332. At-Tabari 5:333. At-Tabari 5 :335

691Surali 2 . Al-tfaqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) i\ eiiSJP j>Je> ogles' ; s' A\ '* ><' Ua)«. — _/^\a) p. ^ JiSU>J*4Zo>~£Ki3fcStW jil «ia 4.^3 ' >*p g~a^ Uilllip gjj^~^JjllaJ A' s^t">' \^t. Z\^.' i -£^.. --:- JI) dJ?Jr=>4^9.1Z^Ai. —3-J-Jj l>J J >4^;jiaUsiyw ji> 4ji)fQ^=tl3 j>*>V' A«X-j ^f 1 ^ * jtiv , •+sS *- ' ^ni - .>< 4i)lj 4)1 Jjb a /££ i* /-** (*^=* > iVerily, in this is a sign far you} testifying to my truth in what I was sent with, my prophethood, and my command to you to obey Talut, <£#& *£& \if you are indeed believers .} in Allah and the Hereafter.” JS jjL£jL OjJlk jdi CH*^ Cj~* iii dS', A ." ""(' : ' :jr cf4,} o""i*** V/,/*• Cr* Xs^ i-'mhj Mi ' • !<•: ? ! ' CT<* < H *—i **\$. -o> s> ,oJC Ui J44 xi 'J ijd ,££ i£i: o LJ Xljli? (^ ^jL; <^i> jvi // cr,® J uLAjdl' ^249. Then when Talut set out with the army, he said: “Verily, Allah will try you by a river. So whoever drinks thereof, he is not of me ; and xohoever tastes it not, he is of me, except him who takes (thereof) in the hollow of his hand." Yet, they drank thereof, all, except a faro of them . So when he had crossed it (the river), he and those who believed with him, tftey said: "We have no power this day against Jdliit (Goliath) and his hosts." But those who ktmv with certainty that they were going to meet Allah, said: "Hoiv often has a small group overcome a mighty host by Allah's leave?" And Allah is with As-Sdbirin (the patient).}

Allah states that TalQt, the king of the Children of Israel, marched forth with his soldiers and the Israelites who obeyed him. His army was of eighty thousand then, according to As- Suddi, ' but Allah knows best. Talut said: iif -^>1\$ iVerily, Allah will try you meaning, He will test you with a river, which flowed between Jordan and Palestine, i.e., the Shari'ah river, according to Ibn ‘Abbas and others., 2) He continued. iSo whoever drinks thereof, he is not of me;} meaning, shall not accompany me today, 4i^s. if^ ^ iand whoever tastes it not, he is of me, except him who takes (thereof) in the hollow ofhis hand meaning, there is no harm in this case. Allah then said: 4-i ^ 1kpf iYet, they drank thereof, all, except afew ofthem.} Ibn Jurayj stated that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “Whoever took some of it (the river’s water) in the hollow of his hand, quenched his thirst; as for those who drank freely from it, their thirst was not quenched.” Ibn Jarir reported that Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib said, “We used to say that the Companions of Muhammad jg who accompanied him on the battle of Badr were more than three hundred and ten, just as many as the soldiers who crossed the river with Talut. Only those who believed crossed the river with him.”131 Al-Bukhari also reported this . This is why Allah said: Li; o Z5& 'J ijd . At-Tabari 5:339. [21 At-Tabari 5:340. At-Tabari 5:345,346,347. 141 Fath Al-Bari 7 :339

693Surah 2. Al-Bacjarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) iSo when he had crossed it (the river), he and those who believed with him, they said: "We have no power this day against Jdliit (Goliath) and his hosts."} This Ayah indicates that the Israelites (who remained with Saul) thought that they were few in the face of their enemy who were many then. So, their knowledgeable scholars strengthened their resolve by stating that Allah’s promise is true and that triumph comes from Allah Alone, not from the large numbers or the adequacy of the supplies. They said to them: i"How often has a small group overcome a mighty host by Allah's leave?"And Allah is with As-Sabirin (the patient).} \L& y>\ ».j» jiiij !*&}& <3ll Vjlj ttlj jLU&J iif ^ .— -l'* wtlij Jc J—Si JJ , m 1 4#<££3® St)^^ isjs 4250. And when they advanced to meet Jdliit (Goliath) and his forces, they invoked: "Our Lord! Pour forth on us patience, and set firm our feet and make us victorious over the disbelieving people."} 4251. So they routed them by Allah's

leave and Dawud (David) killed Jdliit (Goliath), and Allah gave him (Ddwud) the kingdom [after the death of Tdlut and Samuel] and Al-Hikmah (prophethood), and taught him of that which He willed. And if Alldh did not check one set of people by means of another, the earth would indeed be full of mischief. But Alldh is full of bounty to the 'Alarnin (mankind, Jinn and all that exists).} 4252. These are the verses of Alldh, We recite them to you (O Muliammad jfe) in truth, and surely, you are one of the Messengers (of Allah.)} When the faithful party, who were few under the command of Taltit, faced their enemy, who were many under the command of Jalut,

4(^> lli 'jHj^ ithey invoked: "Our Lord! Pourforth on us patience..."} meaning, send down patience on us from You. i\&63 ±pS} iand setfirm ourfeet meaning, against the enemy and save us from running away and from feebleness, iand make us victorious over the disbelieving people.} Allah said: 4So they routed them by Allah's leave} meaning, they defeated and overwhelmed them by Allah's aid and support. Then, iand Ddwud killed Jalut} Israelite accounts claimed that (Prophet) David killed Goliath with a slingshot that he had, which he launched at Goliath causing his death. TalCit promised that whoever killed Jalut, would marry his daughter and would share his kingship and authority. He kept his promise. Later, the kingship was transferred to Prophet Dawud in addition to being granted Prophethood by Allah. So, Allah said: 4d&l\ & fcSi 4 . . .and Allah gave him (Ddwud) the kingdom} that TalQt had and, iand Al-Hikmah} that comes with the prophethood, meaning, after Shamwil. (Allah then said:)

695Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (225 - 252) (Part-2) iand taught him of that which He willed.} meaning, what He willed of the knowledge that He bestowed on (Prophet) Dawud. Next, Allah said: ;uit &*£> iAnd if Allah did not check one set of people by means of another, the earth would indeed be full of mischief.} This Ayah indicates that if it were not for the fact that Allah checks one set of people with another, such as when Talut and the bravery of Dawud helped the Children of Israel (against Goliath), then people would have perished. Similarly, Allah said: JiGlt \$ iFor had it not been that Allah checks one set of people by means of another, monasteries, churches, synagogues, and Masjids, wherein the Name of Allah is mentioned much, would surely, have been pulled down.} (22:40) Allah then said: & J—i jj Sit iBut Allah is full of bounty to the 'Alamitt (mankind, Jinn and all that exists)} meaning, by His mercy and favor He fixes some of them by some others. Surely, Allah has the wisdom, the supreme authority and the clear proof against His creation in all of His actions and statements. Allah said: U && iThese are the verses of Allah, We recite them to you (O Muhammad jfe) in truth, and surely, you are one of the Messengers (of Allah).} This Ayah states, These Ayat (verses) of Allah that We have narrated for you in truth conform to the exact manner that these stories have occurred and to the truth that still remain

in the (Divine) Books that the scholars of the Children of Israel have and know. Allah said: O Muhammad, iyou arc iotie of the Messengers (of Allah)) emphatically stating the truth of his prophethood741 "w This is the End of Volume One with the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, verse. 252.. Volume Two begins with Surat Al-Baqarah, verse. 253.

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - 'Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - ('Atiyah) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn 'Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet aS- - Az-Zuhri [Muhammad bin Shihab] reporting from or about the Prophet - 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr reporting from or about the Prophet sg. - 'Ikrimah reporting from or about the Prophet jt. - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet 53. All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced.

Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet ﷺ, but they report from companions of the Prophet ﷺ, while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-'Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, 'Ata' (bin Abi Rabah), 'Ata' Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Ash-Shabbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet ﷺ, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki', Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn 'Atiyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

4* GiXi JG')' Jli ^ ^ '* *' £»JJ Alii p-6 ^ O'. X3-& C-^j-> gJW, >rV JidS' G iif *ud jij cf-i-j!' G jGj j*- *jJu it? <jiyJ' ijsa \$y &%\$ aa o* (*r4 d*») d1 (*A ^3j ijiddit G Is' ltd Jj) 4^ 44 1* 4*4 4253. Those Messengers! We preferred some of them to others; to some of them Allah spoke (directly); others He raised to degrees (of honor); and to 'Isa, the son of Maryam, We gave clear proofs and evidences, and supported him with Ruh-il-Qudus [Jibril]. If Allah had willed, succeeding generations would not have fought against each other, after clear Verses of Allah Iwd come to them, but they differed - some of them believed and others disbelieved. If Allah had willed, they would not have fought against one another, but Allah does what He wills.} jSSlfeS ** ^tI 4i>p&tj* ofl<\$&(*-\$«*«» ^^ S", ' > ZX\ ' •(' "t \ l>niP*tofU 1U* 4ji' ai • A ,i'-js,ss A A.^ its".' £GpXVIw \T.x*^^ini4: 4 Allah Honored Some Prophets Above Others Allah states that He has honored some Prophets to others. For instance, Allah said, 4iJ>j t2*J tfj? '& iAnd indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others, and to Dawud We gave the Zabur (Psalms)} [17:55]. In the Ayah above, Allah said,

19 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) argument, such as the incident mentioned in the Hadith. The Hadith indicates that it is not up to creation to decide which Prophet is better, for this is Allah's decision. The creation is only required to submit to, obey and believe in Allah's decision. Allah's statement, 'We gave 'Isa, the son of Maryam, clear signs' refers to the proofs and unequivocal evidences that testify to the truth that 'Isa delivered to the Children of Israel, thus testifying that he was Allah's servant and His Messenger to them. And supported him with Ruh-il-Qudus) meaning Allah aided "Isa with Jibril, peace be upon him. Allah then said, 'If Allah had willed, succeeding generations would not have fought against each other, after clear Verses of Allah had come to them, but they differed - some of them believed and others disbelieved. If Allah had willed, they would not have fought against one another. meaning all this happened by Allah's decree, and this is why He said next, 'But Allah does what He wills.) % %L% }y_ 'Sy> & Sf oj XL. irp: \$0 4254. O you who believe! Spend of that with which We have provided for you, before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession. And it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers.)>

Allah commands His servants to spend for His sake, in the path of righteousness, from what He has granted them, so that they acquire and keep the reward of this righteous deed with their Lord and King. Let them rush to perform this deed in this life, it's \$ d jJ ^before a Day comes) meaning, the Day of Resurrection, 4 •“ 'ij <&» j*~? iwhen there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession .) This Ayah indicates that on that Day, no one will be able to bargain on behalf of himself for ransom himself with any amount, even if it was the earth's fill of gold; nor will his friendship or relation to anyone benefit him. Similarly, Allah said, ^ 1 Vj V>Ljl Jj-uA' j iThen, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another) [23:101], /9*ss s x %) iNor intercession) meaning, they will not benefit by the intercession of anyone. Allah's statement, iand it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers) indicates that no injustice is worse than meeting Allah on that Day while a disbeliever. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Ata' bin Dinar said, "All thanks are due to Allah Who said, pa Sfi&ij) iand it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers) but did not say, 'And it is the wrongdoers who are the disbelievers.' m Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :966

22 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) &Vf je 4 C 'i£ 'g £* -v JjSK ^^ &> oi >ur^ . Vj p t*j uy l* jU*> "ify i»X* jii; ifji' IS ,>• o|r*" J*J '«'***» 1lj Cj'jiU' *~?S *li CLi ^ j*Jc 4,»“ 4255. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists. Neither slumber nor sleep overtakes Him. To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth. Who is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission? He knows what happens to them (His creatures) in this world, and what will happen to them in the Hereafter. And they will never compass anything of His Knowledge except that which He wills. His Kursi extends over the heavens and the earth, and He feels no fatigue in guarding and preserving them. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} The Virtue of Ayat Al-Kursi This is Ayat Al-Kursi and tremendous virtues have been associated with it, for the authentic Hadith describes it as 'the greatest Ayah in the Book of Allah.' Imam Ahmad recorded that TJBayy bin Ka*b said that the Prophet jg asked him about the greatest Ayah in the Book of Allah, and TJBayy answered, "Allah and His Messenger know better." When the Prophet repeated his question several times, TJBayy said, "Ayat Al- Kursi The Prophet commented, i IgJ jl 10Jui 1 i ^jjIj Ui jJLdl ^ xp 4Congratulations for having knowledge, O Abu Al-Mundhir! By He in Whose Hand is my soul! This Ayah has a tongue and two lips with which she praises the King (Allah) next to the leg of the Throne .» This Hadith was also collected by Muslim¹² , but he did not Ahmad 5 :14. 121 Muslim 1 :556.

include the part that starts with, "By He in Whose Hand..." Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Ayyub said that he had some dates and a Ghoul' used to take some, and he complained to the Prophet. The Prophet jg said to him, "When you see her, say, 'In the Name of Allah, answer to the Messenger of Allah'." Abu Ayyub said that when she came again, he said these words and he was able to grab her. She begged, "I will not come again," so Abu Ayyub released her. Abu Ayyub went to the Prophet jg and the Prophet asked him, "What did your prisoner do?" Abu Ayyub said, "I grabbed her and she said twice, 'I will not come again,' and I released her." The Prophet jg said, "She will come back." Abu Ayyub said, "So I grabbed her twice or three times, yet each time [I would release her when] she vowed not to come back. I would go to the Prophet jg who would ask me, "What is the news of your prisoner?' I would say, I grabbed her, then released her when she said that she would not return.' The Prophet sg would say that she would return. Once, I grabbed her and she said, 'Release me and I will teach you something to

recite so that no harm touches you, that is, Ayat Al-Kursi' Abu Ayyub went to the Prophet ﷺ and told him, and the Prophet said, "She is liar, but she told the truth."*21 At-Tirmidhi recorded this Hadith in the chapter of the virtues of the Qur'an and said, "Hasan Gharib."*31 In Arabic, 'Ghoul' refers to the Jinn when they appear at night. Al-Bukhari recorded a similar story in his Sahih from Abu Hurayrah, in the chapters on the virtues of the Qur'an and

the description of Shaytan. In this narration, Abu Hurayrah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 720–726]

said, "Allah's Messenger assigned me to keep watch over the Sadaqah (charity) of Ramadan. A person snuck in and started taking handfuls of foodstuff. I caught him and said, "By Allah, I will take you to Allah's Messenger.' He said, 'Release me, for I am meek and have many dependents and am in great need.' I released him, and in the morning Allah's Messenger ﷺ asked 111 That is a category of the Jinn , attributed with many different characteristics by different scholars 121 Ahmad 5 :422 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :183

23Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) me, What did your prisoner do yesterday, O Abu Hurayrah?' I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! He complained of being needy and of having many dependents, so I pitied him and let him go.' Allah's Messenger said, Indeed, he told you a lie and will be coming again.' I believed that he would show up again, for Allah's Messenger ﷺ had told me that he would return. So, I watched for him. When he (showed up and) started stealing handfuls of foodstuff, I caught hold of him again and said, 'I will definitely take you to Allah's Messenger.' He said, 'Leave me, for I am very needy and have many dependents. I promise I will not come back again.' I pitied him and let him go. In the morning Allah's Messenger ﷺ asked me, What did your prisoner do last night, O Abu Hurayrah!' I replied, 'O Allah's Messenger! He complained of his great need and of too many dependents, so I took pity on him and set him free.' Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, Verily, he told you a lie; he will return.' I waited for him attentively for the third time, and when he (came and) started stealing handfuls of the foodstuff, I caught hold of him and said, 'I will surely take you to Allah's Messenger as it is the third time you promised not to return, yet you returned.' He said, 'Let me teach you some words which Allah will give you benefit from.' I asked, What are they?' He replied, Whenever you go to bed, recite Ayat Al-Kursi- AUahu la ilaha ilia Huwal-Hayyul-Qayyum, till you finish the whole verse. (If you do so), Allah will appoint a guard for you who will stay with you, and no Shaytan will come near you until morning.' So, I released him. In the morning, Allah's Messenger ﷺ asked, What did your prisoner do yesterday?' I replied, 'O Allah's Messenger! He claimed that he would teach me some words by which Allah will grant me some benefit, so I let him go.' Allah's Messenger ﷺ asked, What are they?' I replied, 'He said to me: Whenever you go to bed, recite Ayat Al-Kursi from the beginning to the end, AUahu la ilaha ilia Huwal-Hayyul-Qayyum. He further said to me: (If you do so), Allah will appoint a guard for you who will stay with you, and no Shaytan will come near you until morning.' (One of the narrators) then commented that they (the Companions) were very keen to do good deeds. The Prophet ﷺ said, 'He spoke the truth, although he is a liar. Do you know whom you were talking to, these three nights, O Abu Hurayrah?' Abu Hurayrah said, 'No.' He said, It

25 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ^ ^ VI '4 v iAlldh! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists£ [2:255]; in Al 'Imran, it is in. 1 'h4 v iAlif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists} [3:1-2], while in Ta-Ha, it is in, & </4 :j\$ iAtid (all) faces shall be humbled before (Allah), the Ever Living, the One Who sustains and protects all that exists} [20 : 1 1 |." AyatAl-Kursi has Ten Complete Arabic Sentences Allah's statement, 4S* V] id] '*d &} iAlldh! None has the right to be worshipped but He } mentions that Allah is the One and Only Lord of all creation. Allah's statement, iAl-Hayyul-Qayyum} testifies that Allah is the Ever Living, Who never dies, Who sustains everyone and everything. All creation stands in need of Allah and totally relies on Him, while He is the Most Rich, Who stands in need of nothing created. Similarly, Allah said, i->y\ iJojij fju o' j^j} iAnd among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command} [30:25]. Allah's statement, iNeither slumber nor sleep overtakes Him} means, no shortcoming, unawareness or ignorance ever

touches Allah. Rather, He is aware of, and controls what every soul earns, has perfect watch over everything, nothing escapes His knowledge, and no secret matter is secret to Him. Among His perfect attributes, is the fact that He is never effected by slumber or sleep. Therefore, Allah's statement, iNeitlier slumber overtakes Him} indicates that no unawareness due to slumber ever overtakes Allah. Allah said afterwards, inor sleep}, which is stronger than slumber. It is recorded in the Sahbf 1 ^ that Abu Musa said, "The Messenger of Allah jg delivered a speech regarding four words: J** £*y. la - -jH O' Vj jli 'J ~ J 3} J^ J^e-j < Jj jUIJ lAllah does not sleep, and it does not befit His majesty that He sleeps. He lowers the scales and raises them. The deeds of the day are resurrected in front of Him before the deeds of the night, and the deeds of the night before the deeds of the day. His Veil is light, or fire, and if He removes it, the rays from His Face would burn whatever His sight reaches of His creation .» 4. Allah's statement, £ Uj Oy. ,ji Ji U 4J^ iTo Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth} indicates that everyone is a servant for Allah, a part of His kingdom and under His power and authority. Similarly, Allah said, ^ | » /" i' * <'»» hi Muslim 1 :16 1

27 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) _ iThere is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious (Allah) as a servant. Verily, He knoivs each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection (without any helper, or protector or defender)} [19:93-95]. 5. Allah's statement, <(W7jo is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?) is similar to His statements. cA ft Sit j 4 i'1 there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with [53:26], and, f <"< y ' ^ ty+y Ky\ 4o^' A. "i }They cannot intercede except for him with whom He is pleased [21:28]. These Ayat assert Allah's greatness, pride, and grace, and that no one dares to intercede with Him on behalf of anyone else, except by His permission. Indeed, the Hadith about the intercession, states that the Prophet% said, :juj ji 4i! iti U ^e-xx o>J l_f\ «/ will stand under the Throne and fall in prostration, and Allah will alloio me to remain in that position as much as He wills. I will thereafter be told, "Raise your head, speak and you zvill be heard, intercede and your intercession ivill be accepted" . The Prophet then said, "He zvill allozo me a proportion zohom l zvill enter into Paradise."n11 6. Allah's statement, ^ Muslim 1 : 180.

He knows what happens to them (His creatures) in this world, and what will happen to them in the Hereafter^ this refers to His perfect knowledge of all creation; its past, present and future. Similarly, Allah said that the angels proclaimed; 'And we (angels) descend not except by the command of your Lord (O Muhammad jg) . To Him belongs what is before us and

what is behind us, and what is between those two; and your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 726–767]

Lord is neverforgetful (19:64). 7. Allah's statement, 'And they will never compass anything of His Knowledge except that which He wills', asserts the fact that no one attains any part of Allah's knowledge except what Allah conveys and allows. This part of the Ayah indicates that no one ever acquires knowledge of Allah and in His Attributes, except what He conveys to them. For instance, Allah said, 'But they will never compass anything of His knowledge (20 :110). 8. Allah said, 'His Kursi extends over the heavens and the earth.' Wald' narrated in his Tafsir that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Kursi is the footstool, and no one is able to give due consideration to (Allah's) Throne." Al-Hakim recorded this Hadith in his Mustadrafo2] from Ibn 'Abbas, who did not relate it to the Prophet jg. Al-Hakim said, "It is Sahlh according to the criteria At-Tabarani 12:39. 121 Al-Hakim 2 :282

of the Two Sahihs, and they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it." In addition, Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "If the seven heavens and the seven earths were flattened and laid side by side, they would add up to the size of a ring in a desert, compared to the Kursi." 9. Allah said, 'And He feels no fatigue in guarding and preserving them' meaning, it does not burden or cause Him fatigue to protect the heavens and earth and all that is in between them. Rather, this is an easy matter for Him. Further, Allah sustains everything, has perfect watch over everything, nothing ever escapes His knowledge and no matter is ever a secret to Him. All matters are insignificant, modest and humble before Him. He is the Most Rich, worthy of all praise. He does what He wills, and no one can ask Him about what He does, while they will be asked. He has supreme power over all things and perfect alertness concerning everything. He is the Most High, the Greatest, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, and no Lord other than Him. 10. Allah's statement, 'And He is the Most High, the Most Great' is similar to His statement, 'the Most Great, the Most High' (13:9). These and similar Aydt and authentic Hadiths about Allah's Attributes must be treated the way the Salaf (righteous ancestors) treated them by accepting their apparent meanings without equating them (with the attributes of the creation) or altering their apparent meanings. ft ill ^\$\$\$ fjfii .-'l-^ 111 Ibn Abi HStim 3:981.

30 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir 4256. There is no compulsion in religion. Verily, the right path has become distinct from the zorong path. Whoever disbelieves in Tdghiit and believes in Allah, then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break. And Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.'f No Compulsion in Religion Allah said, 'There is no compulsion in religion), meaning, "Do not force anyone to become Muslim, for Islam is plain and clear, and its proofs and evidence are plain and clear. Therefore, there is no need to force anyone to embrace Islam. Rather, whoever Allah directs to Islam, opens his heart for it and enlightens his mind, will embrace Islam with certainty. Whoever Allah blinds his heart and seals his hearing and sight, then he will not benefit from being forced to embrace Islam." It was reported that the Ansar were the reason behind revealing this Ayah, although its

indication is general in meaning. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said (that before Islam), “When (an Ansar) woman would not bear children who would live, she would vow that if she gives birth to a child who remains alive, she would raise him as a Jew. When Banu An-Nadlr (the Jewish tribe) were evacuated [from Al-Madlnah], some of the children of the Ansar were being raised among them, and the Ansar said, “We will not abandon our children.’ Allah revealed, 4’jii £** j5 jj’ 4 ‘i) iThere is no compulsion in religion. Verily, the right path has become distinct from the zorong path.)”¹¹¹ Abu Dawud and An-Nasa’i¹¹² ‘ also recorded this Hadlth. As for the Hadith that Imam Ahmad recorded, in which Anas said that the Messenger of Allah sg said to a man, At-Tabari 5:407. Abu Dawud 3 :132 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :304

«"Embrace Islam." The man said, "I dislike it." The Prophet ss said, "Even if you dislike if." First, this is an authentic Hadith, with only three narrators between Imam Ahmad and the Prophet ig. However, it is not relevant to the subject under discussion, for the Prophet sg did not force that man to become Muslim. The Prophet sg merely invited this man to become Muslim, and he replied that he does not find himself eager to become Muslim. The Prophet jg said to the man that even though he dislikes embracing Islam, he should still embrace it, “for Allah will grant you sincerity and true intent.’ Tawhid is the Most Trustworthy Handhold Allah’s statement, iWhoever disbelieves in Tdghut and believes in Allah, then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break. And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knmoer is in reference to, “Whoever shuns the rivals of Allah, the idols, and those that Shaytan calls to be worshipped besides Allah, whoever believes in Allah’s Oneness, worships Him alone and testifies that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, then i&jif 4then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold.} Therefore, this person will have acquired firmness [in the religion] and proceeded on the correct way and the straight path. Abu Al-Qasim Al-Baghawi recorded that ‘Umar said, “Jibt means magic, and Tdghut means Shaytan. Verily, courage and cowardice are two instincts that appear in men, the courageous fights for those whom he does not know and the coward runs away from defending his own mother. Man’s honor resides with his religion and his status is based upon m Ahmad 3 :181

his character, even if he was Persian or Nabatian.”^{1 11} 'Umar’s statement that Taghut is Shaytan is very sound, for this meaning includes every type of evil that the ignorant people of Jdhiliyyah (pre Islamic era of ignorace) fell into, such as worshipping idols, referring to them for judgement, and invoking them for victory. Allah’s statement, i‘\X (Cm i 4then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break> means, “He will have hold of the true religion with the strongest grasp.” Allah equated this adherence to the firm handhold that never breaks because it is built solid and because its handle is firmly connected. This is why Allah said here, 4then he has grasped the most trustworthy handhold that will never break. Mujahid said, “The most trustworthy handhold is Iman (faith). ”*²¹ As-Suddi said that it refers to Islam. [3] Imam Ahmad recorded that Qays bin ‘Abbad said, “I was in the Masjid when a man whose face showed signs of humbleness came and prayed two Rak'ahs that were modest in length. The people said. This is a man from among the people of Paradise.’ When he left, I followed him until he entered his house, and I entered it after him and spoke with him. When he felt at ease, I said to him, When you entered the Masjid, the people said such and such things.’ He said, ‘All praise is due to Allah! No one should say what he has no knowledge of. I will tell you why they said that. I saw a vision during the time of the Messenger of Allah, and I narrated it to him. I saw that I was

in a green garden,' and he described the garden's plants and spaciousness, 'and there was an iron At-Tabari 5:417. Nabatani refers to a people who resided in Jordan, i.e. even if he was not an Arab At-Tabari 5:421 At-Tabari 5:421.

33 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) 0>LIU ' '5 U^» ^ <£>/&& ^_sibij 3\»ii4&fi*»'iji;Li c^L>*cfbbf\N ii>jj^o^3 0*5 i3 4jiif.jcj.*<^4\$ cJJ j^ajlfI,AjUjjij^cSjL;4itAjUlil45_^Jk»J Jf &J. tlJJai'j 4;; I >p ly^J (jV-k&> j4j£ £&tsz6 pole in the middle of the garden affixed in the earth and its tip reached the sky. On its tip, there was a handle, and I was told to ascend the pole. I said, 'I cannot.' Then a helper came and raised my robe from behind and said to me, 'Ascend.' I ascended until I grasped the handle and he said to me, 'Hold on to the handle.' I awoke from that dream with the handle in my hand. I went to the Messenger of Allah 2g and told him about the vision and he said. «jy^> ^}> lib <-A#l li>» «.SjL' J>- ^^ 5jj^ «As for the garden, it represents Islam; as for the pole, it represents the pillar of Islam; and the handle represents the most trustworthy handhold. You shall remain Muslim until you die. This Companion was 'Abdullah bin Salam.' This Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahih; 21 and Al-Bukhari also recorded it with another chain of narration.*31 111 Ahmad 5:452. *21 Fath Al-Bari 7:161, Muslim 4 : 1930 * Fath Al-Bari 2:418.

j j>ji' JI oXiii Si i^i* tj <A £ 4^ U&\ ji vji & l£&\ {257. Allah is the Walt (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darkensses into light. But as for those xoho disbelieve, their Awliya' (supporters and helpers) are Taghiit (false deities and false leaders), they bring them out from light into darkensses. Those are the dwellers of the Fire, and they will abide therein forever. Allah stated that whoever follows what pleases Him, He will guide him to the paths of peace, that is Islam, or Paradise. Verily, Allah delivers His believing servants from the darkness of disbelief, doubt and hesitation, to the light of the plain, clear, explained, easy and unequivocal truth. He also stated that Shaytan is the supporter of the disbelievers who beautifies the paths of ignorance and misguidance that they follow, thus causing them to deviate from the true path into disbelief and wickedness. iThose arc the dwellers of the Fire, and they will abide therein forever This is why Allah mentioned the light in the singular while mentioned the darkness in the plural, because truth is one, while disbelief comes as several types, all of which are false! Similarly, Allah said, 'Mr- cf fM p.£=ail2 (Xi-ij {And verily, this is my straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path. This He has ordained for you that you may have Taqwa} [6.153J t ji*. {And originated the darkensses and the lights [6:1], and,

ciwJi £} 4to the right and to the lefts} [16:48]. There are many other Ayat on the subject that mention the truth in the singular and falsehood in the plural, because of falsehood's many divisions and branches. , Sji <36 it *it J 4 C? J] J"3 oti dyilif o? ur*.-^ 4^ r^5l 36 \$ Jo T-\./n iJX{m V iljlj 4258. Have you not looked at him who disputed ivith Ibrahim about his Lord (Allah), because Allah had given him the kingdom? When Ibrdftim said (to him): "My Lord is He Who gives life and causes death." He said, "I give life and cause death." Ibrahim said, "Verily, Allldt brings the sun from the east; then bring it you from the west." So the disbeliever was utterly defeated. And Allah guides not the people, who are wrongdoers.} The Debate BetweenIbrahim Al-KhalQandKingNimrod The king who disputed with Ibrahim was King Nimrod, son of Canaan, son of Kush, son of Sam, son of Noah, as Mujahid stated. It was also said that he was Nimrod, son of Falikh, son of 'Abir, son of Shalikh, son of Arfakhshand, son

of Sam, son of Noah. Mujahid said, “The kings who ruled the eastern and western parts of the world were four, two believers and two disbelievers. As for the two believing kings, they were Sulayman bin Dawud and Dhul-Qamayn. As for the two disbelieving kings, they were Nimrod and Nebuchadnezzar. Allah knows best. Allah said, 4Have you not looked} meaning, “With your heart, O Muhammad!” 111 At-Tabari 5 :433

iat him who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord} meaning, about the existence of Allah. Nimrod denied the existence of a god other than himself, as he claimed, just as Fir‘awn said later to his people, 4’— (1-^=0 o lir- L} il know not that you have a god other than me} [28:38]. What made Nimrod commit this transgression, utter disbelief and arrant rebellion was his tyranny and the fact that he ruled for a long time. This is why the Ayah continued, idES\ & iji; \$} 4Because Allah had given him the kingdom.} It appears that Nimrod asked Ibrahim to produce proof that Allah exists. Ibrahim replied, df} iMy Lord is He Wlw gives life and causes death} meaning, “The proof of Allah’s existence is the creations that exist after they were nothing and perish after they had existed. This only proves the existence of the Creator, Who does what He wills, for these things could not have occurred on their own without a Creator who created them, and He is the Lord that I call to for worship, Alone without a partner.” This is when Nimrod said, . t. •J '\$}<f il give life and cause death.} Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ishaq and As-Suddi said that he meant, “Two men who deserved execution were to be brought before me, and I would command that one of them be killed, and he would be killed. I would command that the second man be pardoned, and he would be pardoned. This is how I bring life and death.”*11 However, it appears that since Nimrod did not deny the existence of a Creator, his statement did not mean what Qatadah said it meant. This explanation does not provide an answer to what Ibrahim said. Nimrod arrogantly and defiantly claimed that he was the creator and pretended lil At-Jabari 5 : 433,436,437

37Surah 2. Al-Bagaralt (Part-3) that it was he who brings life and death. Later on, Firawn imitated him and announced, 4I know not that you have a god other than me> [28:38]. This is why Ibrahim said to Nimrod, St^ St a~^ iVerily, Allah brings the sun from the east; then bring it you from the west.} This Ayah means, “You claim that it is you who brings life and death. He who brings life and death controls the existence and creates whatever is in it, including controlling its planets and their movements. For instance, the sun rises eveiyday from the east. Therefore, if you were god, as you claimed,^ bringing life and death, then bring the sun from the west.” Since the king was aware of his weakness, inadequacy and that he was not able to reply to Ibrahim’s request, he was idle, silent and unable to comment. Therefore, the proof was established against him. Allfih said, iAnd Allah guides not the people, who are wrongdoers meaning, Allah deprives the unjust people of any valid proof or argument. Furthermore, their false proof and arguments are annulled by their Lord, and they have earned His anger and will suffer severe torment. The meaning that we provided is better than the meaning that some philosophers offered, claiming that Ibrahim used the second argument because it was clearer than the first one. Rather, our explanation asserts that Ibrahim refuted both claims of Nimrod, all praise is due to Allah. As-Suddi stated that the debate between Ibrahim and Nimrod occurred after Ibrahim was thrown in the fire, for Ibrahim did not meet the king before that day.

3 & p \QxSJ u*= 4dJi4, jj&j -OH fly- 3~=- (jjc iLl oi jU*t jc 4259. Or like the one who passed by a town in ruin up to its roofs. He said : "How will Allah ever bring it to life after its death? So Allah caused him to die for a hundred years, then raised him up (again). He said: "How long did you remain (dead)?" He (the man) said: "(Perhaps) I remained (dead) a day or part of a day. He said : "Nay, you have remained (dead) for a hundred years, look at your food and your drink, they show no change; and look at your donkey! And thus We have made of you a sign for the people. Look at the bones, how We bring them together and clothe them with flesh." When this was clearly shown to him, he said, "I know (now) that Allah is able to do all things.")

The Story of 'Uzayr Allah's statement, 4Mi&4 jj2\$) iHave you not looked at him 10I10 disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord) means, "Have you seen anyone like the person who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord?" Then, Allah connected the Ayah, Jo '£} He 4% iOr like the one who passed by a town in ruin up to its roofs) to the Ayah above by using 'or'. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Ali bin Abi Talib said that the Ayah [2:259] meant 'Uzayr J * Ibn Jarir^ also reported it, and this explanation was also reported by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim from Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Sulayman bin Buraydah J3 I 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1009. At-Tabari 5 :439 f3| At-Tabari 5:439,440, Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1009-1010.

39Suralt 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Mujahid bin Jabr said that the Ayah refers to a man from the Children of Israel, and the village was Jerusalem, after Nebuchadnezzar destroyed it and killed its people. 4in ruin\$ means, it became empty of people. Allah's statement, iup fo its roofs indicates that the roofs and walls (of the village) fell to the ground. TJzayr stood contemplating about what had happened to that city, after a great civilization used to inhabit it. He said, 4 W iOh! How will Allah ever bring it to life after its death?) because of the utter destruction he saw and the implausibility of its returning to what it used to be. Allah said, p£ 21, iii 5SCfc> <fSo Allah caused him to die for a hundred years, then raised him up (again).} The city was rebuilt seventy years after the man (TJzayr) died, and its inhabitants increased and the Children of Israel moved back to it. When Allah resurrected TJzayr after he died, the first organ that He resurrected were his eyes, so that he could witness what Allah does with him, how He brings life back to his body. When his resurrection was complete, Allah said to him, meaning through the angel, 4^je j'1 £3*^ 4" How long did you remain (dead)?" He (the man) said: "(Perhaps) I remained (dead) a day or part of a day."} The scholars said that since the man died in the early part of the day and Allah resurrected him in the latter part of the day, when he saw that the sun was still apparent, he thought that it was the sun of that veiy day. He said, P JJiS iSl* S. <J^ j'")1 4"Or part of a day." He said: "Nay, you have remained (dead) for a hundred years, look at your food and your drink, they

show no change." He had grapes, figs and juice, and he found them as he left them; neither did the juice spoil nor the figs become bitter nor the grapes rot. iAnd look at your donkey!*, "How Allah brings it back to life while you are watching." iZ\l dj&cjS iAnd thus We have made of you a sign for the people that Resurrection occurs. >,CUt 3} J-&V iLook at the bones, how We Nunshizuha meaning, collect them and put them back together. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim, recorded that Kharijah bin Zayd bin Thabit said that his father said that the Messenger of Allah read this Ayah, ihow We Nunshizuha.* Al-Hakim said; "Its chain is Sahih and they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it.",1) The Ayah was

also read, “Nunshiruha” meaning, bring them back to life, as Mujahid stated . 4L£ \SJ3Z, p iAnd clothe them with flesh. As-Suddi said, “ ‘Uzayr observed the bones of his donkey, which were scattered all around him to his right and left, and Allah sent awind that collected the bones from all over the area. Allah then brought every bone to its place, until they formed a full donkey made of fleshless bones. Allah then covered these bones with flesh, nerves, veins and skin. Allah sent an angel 111 Al-Hakim 2 : 234 •2| At-Tabari 5:476.

42Surah 2 . Al-Baaarah (Part-3 who blew life in the donkeys’ nostrils, and the donkey started to bray by Allah’s leave.” All this occurred while TJzayr was watching, and this is when he proclaimed, ^=> ii' \$ jUtl \$He said, "I know (now) that Allah is able to do all things,"} meaning, “I know that, and I did witness it with my own eyes. Therefore, I am the most knowledgeable in this matter among the people ofmy time.” oi’y pj’ J® <3>J' c ti* J-v-' iU^ <s& 4260. And (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead." He (Allah) said: “Do you not believe?” He (Ibrahim) said: "Yes (I believe), but to be stronger in faith.” He said: "Take four birds, then cause them to incline towards you (then slaughter them, cut them into pieces), and then put a portion of them on every hill, and call them, they will come to you in haste. And know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.”} At-Tabari 5 :468 J15 t. a!.£==»(jti i->j 'J* j i3\S \$ \$ ^ ,^4- ip^ J*\$3c£ \J» i r/>-'v. <— f T" ». >~Z*>SC a <#sSi eft r,^3;aujjs-iiir,iiii=ii: ..-j. o^vai irtjl jjj t_#5i i-jlW i&b \$ <3tt jr£* ill J deij LIL- &ut _>j f*->- ^4

icause them to incline towards you> means, cut them to pieces. This is the explanation of Ibn ‘Abbas, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Abu Al-Aswad Ad-Dlli, Wahb bin Munabbih, Al-Hasan and As-SuddiJ Therefore, Ibrahim caught four birds, slaughtered them, removed the feathers, tore the birds to pieces and mixed the pieces together. He then placed parts of these mixed pieces on four or seven hills. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Ibrahim kept the heads of these birds in his hand. Next, Allah commanded Ibrahim to call the birds to him, and he did as Allah commanded him. Ibrahim witnessed the feathers, blood and flesh of these birds fly to each other, and the parts flew each to their bodies, until every bird came back to life and came walking at a fast pace towards Ibrahim, so that the example that Ibrahim was witnessing would become more impressive. Each bird came to collect its head from Ibrahim’s hand, and if he gave the bird another head the bird refused to accept it. When Ibrahim gave each bird its own head, the head was placed on its body by Allah’s leave and power.”121 This is why Allah said, jcp 3 4And know that Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise and no one can overwhelm or resist Him. Whatever Allah wills, occurs without hindrance, because He is the All-Mighty, Supreme above all things, and He is Wise in His statements, actions, legislation and decrees. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ma'mar said that Ayyub said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on what Ibrahim said, 3&& ibut to be stronger in Faith), “To me, there is no Ayah in the Qur’an that brings more hope than this Ayah.”131 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir said that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas met ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin Al-‘As and Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1039,1040. Al-Qurtubi 3:300. At-Jabari 5 :489

said to him, “Which Ayah in the Qur’an carries more hope for you?” Ibn ‘Amr said, 4Say: "O ‘Tbddi (My servants) who have transgressed against themselves (by committing evil deeds and sins)! Despair not.} [39:53]. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “But I say that it is Allah’s statement, ** »«* ^fX *1.1 *** */## * •>* < , . - y y * <3ii Jif pb' 3^ ufO jj* 3c i}^ iAnd (remember) when Ibrahim said, "My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead." He (Allah) said: “Do you not believe?" He (Ibrahim) said: "Yes (I

believe)...} Allah accepted Ibrahim's affirmation when he merely said, Yes.' This Ayah refers to the doubts that attack the heart and the thoughts that Shaytan inspires." ' Al-Hakim also recorded this in Al-Mustadrak and said; "Its chain is Sahih but they did not record it." 2' 4 inv;> Af. Ka. Ajh 4262 . The parable of those who spend their wealth in the way of Allah, is that of a grain (of corn); it grows seven ears, and each ear has a hundred grains. Allah gives manifold increase to whom He wills. And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower.} Rewards of Spending in Allah's Cause This is a parable that Allah made of the multiplication of rewards for those who spend in His cause, seeking His pleasure. Allah multiplies the good deed ten to seven hundred times. Allah said, Ji Xf , . •><'.» f . > ' iThe parable of those who spend their wealth in the way of Allah...} 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1032. 121 Al-Hakim 4:260.

45Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Said bin Jubayr commented, "Meaning spending in Allah's obedience." 1 11 Makhul said that the Ayah means, "Spending on Jihad, on horse stalls, weapons and so forth."*2 ' The parable in the Ayah is more impressive on the heart than merely mentioning the number seven hundred. This Ayah indicates that Allah 'grows' the good deeds for its doers, just as He grows the plant for whoever sows it in fertile land. The Sunnah also mentions that the deeds are multiplied up to seven hundred folds. For instance, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Mas'ud said that a man once gave away a camel, with its bridle on, in the cause of Allah and the Messenger of Allah s|| said, > • ^ , • - ts Aj lli) \ oSfcia "On the Day of Resurrection, you will have seven hundred camels with their bridles. s' Muslim and An-Nasa'i also recorded this Hadith, and Muslim's narration reads, "A man brought a camel with its bridle on and said, 'O Messenger of Allah! This is in the sake of Allah.' The Messenger said, iioji yj, i* Jjj» "You will earn seven hundred camels as reward for it on the Day of Resurrection .»' 4 ' Another Hadith: Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, Jjjj iiiiil - >' > . ' r • -• * ' . __ I*j ijij Xp 'J-'Jtj Ojki Xp ' j 1 Xp . i ^*.1.1,1 "Every good deed that the son of Adam performs will be multiplied ten folds, to seven hundred folds, to many other Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1047. Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1047. ' Ahmad 4 :121 ' Muslim 3 :1505 , An-Nasa'i 6 :49

46 Tafstr Ibn Kathir folds, to as much as Allah wills. Allah said, "Except the fast, for it is for Me and I will reward for it. One abandons his food and desire in My sake." The fasting person has two times of happiness : xohen he breaks his fast and when he meets his Lord. Verily, the odor that comes from the mouth of whoever fasts is more pure to Allah than the scent of musk. Fasting is a shield (against sinning), fasting is a shield [1] Muslim recorded this Hadith)2^ Allah's statement, iAllah gives manifold increase to whom He wills£ is according to the person's sincerity in his deeds. iAnd Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower} meaning, His Favor is so wide that it encompasses much more than His creation, and He has full knowledge in whoever deserves it, or does not deserve it. All the praise and thanks are due to Allah. **6 'ij ti* ijiil uyLij V j»J <3)1 4 . i" - l'." « A *. *> .1- . f. ^ .:> . . , ->v** Jy v <->j- x> isf% v \pn U- && iS 4\$ j m%.% \$£ j#i <s0 *£5 1^% 3£ %C\ 4262 . Tlwse who spend their wealth in the cause of Allah, and do not follow up their gifts with reminders of their generosity or with injury, their reward is with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve. 4263. Kind words and forgiving of faults are better than Sadaqah (charity) followed by injury. And Allah is Rich (free of ^ Ahmad 2 :443. Muslim 2:807.

47 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) all needs) and He is Most Forbearing.} \$264. O you who believe! Do not render in vain your Sadaqah (charity) by reminders of your generosity or by injury, like him who spends his wealth to be seen of men, and he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day. His likeness is the likeness of a smooth rock on which is a little dust; on it falls heavy rain which leaves it bare. They are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people.} To Remind About Charity Given is Forbidden Allah praises those who spend from their money in His cause, and then refrain from reminding those who received the charity of that fact, whether these hints take the form of words or actions. Allah's statement, 4^ 4or with injury}, indicates that they do not cause harm to those whom they gave the charity to, for this harm will only annul the charity. Allah next promised them the best rewards for this good deed, V&> ** |*A*' 4their reward is with their Lord}, indicating that Allah Himself will reward them for these righteous actions. Further, 40n them shall be no fear} regarding the horrors of the Day of Resurrection, 4'^yjk (U 4nor shall they grieve} regarding the offspring that they leave behind and the adornment and delights of this world. They will not feel sorry for this, because they will acquire what is far better for them. Allah then said, 4Kind words} meaning, compassionate words and a

supplication for Muslims, iand forgiving meaning, forgiving an injustice that took the form of actions or words, V-t . <" • v, iare better titan Sadaqah (charity) followed by injury. 4And Allah is Rich} not needing His creation, iMost Forbearing} forgives, releases and pardons them. There are several Hadiths that prohibit reminding people of acts of charity. For instance, Muslim recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, udi Yy. '(4&i v 2*&« J-IUIJ U, StUt :jUl "Three persons whom Allah shall neitlter speak to on the Day of Resurrection nor look at nor purify, and they shall receive a painful torment: he who reminds (the people) of what he gives away, he who lengthens his clothes below the ankles and he who swears an oath while lying, to sell his merchandised This is why Allah said, 'j \p: yj\ £&} 40 you who believe! Do not render in vain your Sadaqah (charity) by reminders of your generosity or by injury} stating that the charity will be rendered in vain if it is followed by harm or reminders. In this case, the reward of giving away charity is not sufficient enough to nullify the harm and reminders. Allah then said, iyp jBj% d- m Muslim 1 :102.

49 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Hike him who spends his xoealth to be seen of men} meaning, "Do not nullify your acts of charity by following them with reminders and harm, just like the charity of those who give it to show off to people." The boasting person pretends to give away charity for Allah's sake, but in reality seeks to gain people's praise and the reputation of being kind or generous, or other material gains of this life. All the while, he does not think about Allah or gaining His pleasure and generous rewards, and this is why Allah said, iya a iand he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day.} Allah next set the example of whoever gives charity to show off. Ad-Dahhak commented that the example fits one who follows his acts of charity with reminders or harm. 111 Allah said, iofcgZ &Z} 4His likeness is the likeness of Safivdn} where Safwan, from is Safwanah, meaning 'the smooth rocks,' vi/ #4^ ion which is little dust; on it falls a Wabil} meaning, heavy rain, H'ZZ t^5>} iwhich leaves it bare.} This Ayah means that heavy rain left the Safivan completely barren of dust. Such is the case with Allah's action regarding the work of those who show off, as their deeds are bound to vanish and disappear, even though people think that these deeds are as plentiful as specks of dust. So Allah said.

iThey are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people. } iXj-t (* ^4 Sit&} 111 At-Tabari 5:527.

J mm 10 s\$M Jj'jl*>L>t} i>ib*-iL.j JJa3jj\jl^\L^oJ^N^J^i->^?t4i^==^ CiliS s'?" t'-5- if " OJjJ^io'(>-£=>Jk>-1 jjjl {njil _j^zjj jU>juUj &&%£&%fl«dj -~r- — t> ^ \$4.1 as i\$ i^a -L-^— 4jUl (jl Il^o-lc^ ** <J ^ A#- wJi^,'_)'4i\j"%^a3j oya_*> djiltj Jt'j T“-” (^ oji ifj5i!LU£ 4S-W? 4265. And the parable of those who spend their wealth seeking Allah's pleasure while they in their own selves are sure and certain that Allah will reward them (for their spending in His cause), is that of a gar- den on a height; heavy rain falls on it and it doubles its yield of har- vest. And if it does not receive heavy rain, light rain suffices it. And Allah is All-Seer (knows well) of what you do.} This is the example of the believers who give away charity seeking only Allah's pleasure, (ji iwhile they in their own selves are sure and certain} meaning, they are certain that Allah shall reward them for these righteous acts with the best rewards. Similarly, in a Hadith collected by Al-Bukhari and Muslim, the Messenger of Allah said, n IjLll>-ij liLiIj j\JlAj Lao ^Whoever fasts Ramadan with faith and expectation ...» meaning, believing that Allah commanded the fast, all the while awaiting His reward for fasting it. m Path Al-Bari 4 :300

Allah's statement, iis that of a garden on a Rabwah means, the example of a garden on 'a height above the ground', as the majority of scholars have stated. Ibn 'Abbas and Ad-Dahhak added that it also has flowing rivers. 11 ' Allah's statement, fWabil falls on it} means, heavy rain as we stated, So it produces its, iyield of harvest} meaning, fruits or produce, 4doubles}, as compared to other gardens. iS& Jtb } And if it does not receive Wdbil, a Tall suffices it.} Ad-Dahhak said that the 'Tali' is light rain.'2 * The Ayah indicates that the garden on the Rabwah is always fertile, for if heavy rain does not fall on it, light rain will suffice for it. Such is the case regarding the believer's good deeds, for they never become barren. Rather, Allah accepts the believer's righteous deeds and increases them, each according to his deeds. This is why Allah said next, oj» «> '<£\$)} iAnd Allah is All-Seer of what you do} meaning, none of His servants' deeds ever escapes His perfect watch. y vpj' jfc -m ^ 111 At-Tabari 5:539. 121 At-Tabari 5:539.

4266. Would any of you wish to have a garden with date palms and vines, with rivers flowing underneath, and all kinds of fruits for him therein, while he is stricken with old age, and his children are weak (not able to look after themselves), then it is struck with a fiery whirlwind, so that it is burnt? Thus does Allah make clear His Aydt to you that you may give thought.} The Example of Evil Deeds Nullifying Good Deeds Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas and Ubayd bin Umayr said that Umar bin Al-Khattab asked the Companions of the Messenger of Allah, "According to your opinion, about whom was this Ayah revealed, Ji |d J iJ} 4Would any of you wish to have a garden with date palms and vines...?}." They said, "Allah knows best." 'Umar became angry and said, "Say we know or we do not know." Ibn Abbas said, "O Leader of the Faithful! I have an opinion about it." Umar said, "O my nephew! Say your opinion and do not belittle yourself." Ibn 'Abbas said, "This is an example set for a deed." Umar said, "What type of deed?" Ibn 'Abbas said, "For a wealthy man who works in Allah's pleasure and then Allah sends Shaytan to him, and he works in disobedience, until he annuls his good works." This HadUh suffices as an explanation for the Ayah, for it explains the example it sets by a person who does good first and then follows it with evil, may Allah save us from this end. So, this man annulled his previous good works with his latter evil works. When he desperately needed the deeds of

the former type, there were none. This is why Allah said, 4^1 Z^} 4while he is stricken with old age, and his children are weak (not able to look after themselves), then it is struck with a whirlwind} with heavy wind, m Fath Al-Bari 8 :49

is fiery, so that it is burnt} meaning, its fruits were burnt and its trees were destroyed. Therefore, what will his condition be like? Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah has set a good parable, and all His parables are good. He said, a %}} 4Wo«W any 0/you wish to have a garden with date palms and vines, with rivers flowing underneath, and all kinds of fruits fir him therein.} But he lost all this in his old age, i'J&f'^} iwhile he is stricken with old age} while his offspring and children are weak just before the end of his life. Then a lightning storm came and destroyed his garden. Then he did not have the strength to grow another garden, nor did his offspring offer enough help. This is the condition of the disbeliever on the Day of Resurrection when he returns to Allah, for he will not have any good deeds to provide an excuse - or refuge - for him, just as the man in the parable had no strength to replant the garden. The disbeliever will not find anything to resort to for help, just as the offspring of the man in the parable did not provide him with help. So he will be deprived of his reward when he most needs it, just as the man in the parable was deprived of Allah's garden when he most needed it, when he became old and his offspring weak."111 In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that the Messenger of Allah used to say in his supplication, jilj «0 Allah! Make Your biggest provision fir me when I am old in age and at the time my life ends.*12 ' I 1 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1074. 121 Al-Hakim 1 :542.

This is why Allah said, i'o&Z p £t Sg 3£?} iThus Allah makes clear to you His Laws in order that you may give thought> meaning, comprehend and understand the parables and their intended implications. Similarly, Allah said. »: ofy. dJbijfy 4And these similitudes We put forward for mankind; hut none will understand them except tlwse who have knowledge (of Allah and His signs)} [29:43]. % *p u *q; j. \&\ rp: 'a# [ff JLi C)1 fjlleij 4-j itP-Z J ~V> *>£% SjLu ii. SiJi tjit'f. os- uj^ oji *3 tis: * 4>:9^ ^5% ijijt uj 4267. O you who believe! Spend of the good things which you have (legally) earned, and of that which We have producedfrom the earth far you, and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it, (though) you would not accept it save ifyou close your eyes and tolerate therein. And know that Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and worthy ofall praise.} 4268. Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahshd' (evil deeds) whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty, and Allah is All- Sufficientfar His creatures' needs, All-Knower.} 4269. He grants Hikmah to whom He wills, and he, to whom Hikmah is granted, is indeed granted abundant good. But none remember (will receive admonition) except men of understanding.} The Encouragement to Spend HonestMoney for Allah's Sake Allah commands His believing servants to spend in charity, as Ibn 'Abbas stated, from the pure, honest money that they

55Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) earned and from the fruits and vegetables that He has grown for them in the land. Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah commanded them to spend from the purest, finest and best types of their money and prohibited spending from evil and dishonest money, because Allah is pure and good and only accepts that which is pure and good." This is why Allah said, iand do not aim at that which is bad* meaning, filthy (impure) money, Ji • i" * •I" *•*«£. * V oy&l K-tf 4to spendfrom it, (though) you would not accept it) meaning, "If you were given this type, you would not take it, except if you tolerate

the deficiency in it. Verily, Allah is far Richer than you. He is in no need of this money, so do not give, for His sake, what you would dislike for yourselves.” It was reported that, (and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it) means, “Do not spend from the dishonest, impure money instead of the honest, pure money.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib commented on Allah’s statement, 40 you who believe! Spend of the good things which you have (legally) earned, and of that which We have produced from the earth for you, and do not aim at that which is bad to spend from it,) that it was revealed about the Ansar. When the season for harvesting date-trees would start, the Ansar would collect ripe- date branches from their gardens and hang them on a rope erected between two pillars in the Masjid of the Messenger of Allah. The poor emigrant Companions would eat from these dates. However, some of them (Ansar) would also add lesser type of dates in between ripe-date branches, thinking they are

allowed to do so. Allah revealed this Ayah about those who did this, 44^ IJX %) iand do not aim at that which is bad to spend from ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, A 'VI *&% ^j) iyou would not accept it save if you close your eyes and tolerate therein) means, “If you had a right on someone who would pay you less than what you gave them, you would not agree until you require more from them to make up the difference. This is why Allah said, J%) isave ifyou close your eyes and tolerate therein) meaning, ‘How do you agree for Me what you do not agree for yourselves, while I have a right to the best and most precious of your possessions?’” Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this Hadith and Ibn Jarir added, “And this is the meaning of Allah’s statement, 4By no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of that which you love)” [4:92] Allah said next, 4JL£ ££& % \fj^ 4And know that Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and worthy of all praise) meaning, “Although Allah commanded you to give away the purest of your money in charity. He is far Richer from needing your charity, but the purpose is that the distance between the rich and the poor becomes less.” Similarly, Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 5:559. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1088 , At-Tabari 5 :565

57Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ipi 3c S.5 %V&& j£& at is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, but it is piety from you that reaches Him> [22:37], Allah is Rich and free of needing anything from any of His creatures, while all of His creatures stand in need of Him. Allah’s bounty encompassing, and what He has never ends. Therefore, whoever gives away good and pure things in charity, let him know that Allah is the Most Rich, His favor is enormous and He is Most Generous, Most Compassionate; and He shall reward him for his charity and multiply it many times. So who would lend to He Who is neither poor nor unjust, Who is worthy of all praise in all His actions, statements, and decisions, of Whom there is neither a deity worthy of worship except Him, nor a Lord other than Him? Shaytan Doubts Concerning Spending in Charity Allah said, y,% to;m && 'jx f£y 4Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahsha'; whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty, and Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. v-jOSCj i. jUa.Jjl ill uO illj .MU* *11 jjn if*3 ‘ ‘ iiJ * J I JjUalljl I# -J J*J JU>JU tjll jf* <,\ "Shaytan has an effect on the son of Adam, and the angel also has an effect. As for the effect of Shaytan, it is by his threatening with evil repercussions and rejecting the truth. As for the effect of the angel, it is by his promise of a good end and believing in the truth. Whoever finds the latter, let him know that it is coming from Allah and let him thank Allah for it. Whoever finds the former, let him seek refuge - with Allah -

from Shaytan . The Prophet then recited, fit; **£2* ,i-% pi {Shaytan threatens you with poverty and orders you to commit Fahsha'; whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himself and bounty^ (1 This is the narration that At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal collected in the book of Tafsir in their Sunan collections . Allah said, <3\$ pSa {Shaytan threatens you with povertyf, so that you hold on to whatever you have and refrain from spending it in Allah's pleasure. iAnd orders you to commit Fahsha>, meaning, "Shaytan forbids you from spending in charity because of the false fear of becoming poor, and he encourages evil deeds, sins, indulging in what is prohibited, and immoral conduct." Allah said, {Whereas Allah promises you forgiveness from Himselfo instead of ie evil that Shaytan enjoins on you, \nd Bounty^ as opposed to the poverty that Shaytan frightens you with, {And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Ktiower.f he Meaning ofAl-Hikmah \llah said, 4*^4 a* 4%} Ibn Abi Hatim 3 : 1090 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :332, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :305.

59Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) - > 1 4dLjU (Jjji «_4olUj 'll1M .J.ilxju r'i > •> x . \La££>j »i^5 1 ^ j>- £=LLC. 7aSvj |>-=lJjji- iHe grants Hikmah to whom He wills. 'Ali bin Abi Jalhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "That is knowledge of the Qur'an. For instance, the abrogating and the abrogated, what is plain and clear and

what is not as plain and clear, what it allows, and what it does not allow, and its parables."111 Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Mas*ud said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, fcj J ^ JLli V» ^e. tSai.'i MU ill otl <ii obi j4-jj j, kjr^L3i "There is no envy except in two instances: a person whom Allah has endowed zoith wealth and he spends it righteously, and a person whom Allah has given Hikmah and he judges bu it and teaches it to others.^ This was also collected by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, An-Nasa'i, Ibn Majah. |J| Allah's statement, :*U— —jyy>tep-* jj> —»>*•jj ' ijiji iBut none remember (will receive admonition) except men of At-Jabari 5:576. 121 Ahmad 1 :432. Fath Al-Bari 1 :199, Muslim 1 :559, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 3:426 Ibn Majah 2:1407.

60 Tafair Ibn Katliir understanding.} means, "Those who will benefit from the advice are those who have sound minds and good comprehension with which they understand the words (of advice and reminder) and their implications." o; iii-X «i \ djf* j oi j' oi 5.# ^ StW Ji-f £* 'Xfj 1^=0^ •X*- 4270. And whatever you spend far spendings (e.g., in Sadaqah) or whatever vow you make, be sure Allah knows it all. Andfar the wrongdoers there are no helpers. 4271. Ifyou disclose your Sadaqdt (almsgiving), it is well; but ifyou conceal them and give them to the poor, that is betterfor you. (Allah) will expiate you some of your sins. And Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.} Allah states that He has perfect knowledge of the good deeds performed by all of His creation, such as charity and various vows, and He rewards tremendously for these deeds, provided they are performed seeking His Face and His promise. Allah also warns those who do not work in his obedience, but instead disobey His command, reject His revelation and worship others besides Him: 4jfa^7 j 4Andfar the wrongdoers there are no helpers .} meaning, who will save them from Allah's anger and torment on the Day of Resurrection. The Virtue ofDisclosing or Concealing Charity Allah said, 4ji ciixSli 14-5 4Ifyou disclose your Sadaqdt, it is well meaning, "It is well ifyou make known the charity that you give away." Allah's statement, 4But if you conceal them and give them to the poor, that is

62Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3 betterfor you this indicates that concealing charity is better than disclosing it, because it protects one from showing off and boasting. However, if there is an apparent

wisdom behind disclosing the charity, such as the people imitating this righteous act, then disclosing it becomes better than concealing it. The Messenger of Allah sg said, «He who utters aloud Qur'dnic recitation is just like he who discloses charity acts. He who conceals Qur'dnic recitation is just like he who conceals charity acts . The Ayah indicates that it is better that acts of charity be concealed, as reiterated by the Hadith that the Two Sahihs recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jg said, [^] I*-*-?- 1 'jil ^ UUi O'jJjj ijill ou ai -jf> Jfjj go;> O lii yj olii :jUi olj ;i^ll J4-jj jUi; 7 tUUaU jixA jxk: lAllah will give shade to seven on the Day when there will be no shade but His. (They are:) a just ruler, a youth who has been brought up in the worship of Allah, two persons who love each other only for Allah's sake who meet and part in Allah's cause only, a man whose heart is attached to the Masjids from the time he departs the Masjid until he returns to it, a person who remembers Allah in seclusion and his eyes are then flooded with tears, a man who refuses the call of a charming woman of noble birth for illicit intercourse with her and says, 7 fear Allah, Lord of the worlds', and a man who gives charitable gifts so secretly that his left hand does not know what his right hand has given . »¹²¹ 111 Abu Dawud 2:83. 121 Fath Al-Bari 3 :344 , Muslim 2:715.

Allah's statement, irt i(Allah) will expiate you some of your sins> means, in return for giving away charity, especially if it was concealed. Therefore, you will gain goodness by your rank being raised, and your sins being forgiven. Allah's statement, 4if- A ^.>4 iAtid Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do) means, "No good deed that you perform escapes His knowledge, and He shall reward for it." yy. AA' Ji-a -S' ££ vA 4 ljj_ ^ 'Z ;ti' j^Lssar ^>;Vf *>j *i' -A*- 0; iyi— o ^5-UJf *£> •—jy- v5 f-jjj AiA >4-* ^y*i A- 'i 4272. Not upon you (Muhammad jfe) is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills. And whatever you spend in good, it is for yourselves, when you spend not except seeking Allah's Face. And whatever you spend in good, it will be repaid to you in full, and you shall not be wronged.) i273. (Charity is) for Fuqard' (the poor), who in Allah's cause are restricted (from travel), and cannot move about in the land (for trade or work). The one who knows them not, thinks that they are rich because of their modesty. You may know them by their mark, they do not beg of people at all. And whatever you spend in good, surely Allah knows it well.) 4274. Tlwse who spend their zwealth (in Allah's cause) by night and day, in secret and in public, they shall have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.)

63Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-1) Giving Charity to Polytheists Abu 'Abdur-Rahman An-Nasal recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that they, "Disliked giving charity to their polytheist relatives, but were later on allowed to give it to them when they inquired about this matter, and this Ayah was revealed, £ &W ^ ^A && St 'J-s^ A' i> *5 4N^t upon you (Muhammad jg) is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills. And whatever you spend in good, it is for yourselves, wlten you spetid not except seeking Allah's Face And whatever you spend in good, it will be repaid to you in full, and you slmll not be wronged.^*1 Allah's statement, 4And whatever you spend in good, it isfor yourselves is similar to His other statement. iWhosoevcr does righteous good deed, it is for (the benefit of) his ousmself> There are many other similar Aydt in the Qur'an. Allah said next, t-t:J ^ 4When you spend not except seeking Allah's Face.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented, "Whenever the believer spends, including what he spends on himself, he seeks Allah's Face with it." 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said that the Ayah means "You give away charity for the sake of Allah. Therefore, you will not be asked about the deeds [or wickedness] of those who receive it.' This is a sound meaning indicating that whenone spends in charity for Allah's sake,

then his reward will be An-Nasat in Al-Kubrd 6 :305 I">1 Ibn Abi B&tim 3:1 115. Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1115.

with Allah. He will not be asked if the charity unintentionally reached righteous, evil, deserving or undeserving persons, for he will be rewarded for his good intention. The proof to this statement is the Ayah, 4And whatever you spend in good, it will be repaid to you in full, and you shall not be wronged.} The Two Sahihs recorded a Hadith by Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah gg g§ said, li iCjIj -ii iji aLUI *iIJ : Jlii ^ (3-UaJ vlyS>Cj jjuai :jjijlAS Ijiw'li Ji I «iIU' anil iu :ju^ JU iun i3-> ijjLS. Jj ^ oxi; ^ a^JI^ r^ JjiJj t^j . j«•-»- jI ol^ll btj i oJLi AS* Ui td <ci^ I4; jI JjLi-l Jilj k<i)l olitfi tlj uA wan said, "Tonight, I shall give charity." He went out with his charity and (unknowingly) gave it to an adulteress. The next morning the people said that alms were given to an adulteress. The man said, "O Allah! All the praises are far You. (I gave my alms) to an adulteress. Tonight, I shall give alms again." He went out with his charity and (unknowingly) gave it to a rich person. The next morning (the people) said, "Last night, a wealthy person was given alms." He said, " Allah! All the praises are far You. (I gave alms) to a wealthy man. Tonight, 1 shall again give charity." So he went out with his charity and (unknowingly) gave it to a thief. The next morning (the people) said, "Last night, a thief was given alms." He said, "O Allah! All the praises are far You. (I have given alms) to an adulteress, a wealthy man and a thief." Then, someone came to him and said, "The alms that you gave away were accepted. As far the adulteress, the alms might make her abstain from adultery. As far the wealthy man, it might

65Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) make him take a lesson and spend his wealth that Allah has given him. As for the thief, it might make him abstain from stealing ."o* 11 Who Deserves Charity Allah said, Charity is) for the poor, ivho in Allah's cause are restricted (from travel meaning, the migrants who migrated to Allah and His Messenger, resided in Al-Madinah and did not have resources that sufficiently provided them with their needs, 3} iAnd cannot Darbdti (move about) in the land} meaning, "They cannot travel in the land to seek means of livelihood." Allah said in other instances [using a variation of the word Darban i't&4 ot lir-uS '£4*- 0-4 cjOV' 4 iAnd when you (Muslims) travel in the land, there is no sin on you ifyou shorten the Salali (the prayer)} [4:101], and, ot Jfjji J OJj* fL* 'bflS* J iHe knows that there will be some among you sick, others traveling through the land, seeking ofAllah's bounty, yet others fighting in Allah's cause} [73:20]. Allah then said, iJ&\ lysZ} iThe one who knows them not, thinks that they are rich because of their modesty} meaning, those who do not know their situation think that they are well-off, because they are modest in their clothes and m Fath At-Bari 3 :340 , Muslim 2 :709

Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said said, "My mother sent me to the Messenger of Allah jfe to ask him for help, but when I came by him I sat down. The Prophet faced me and said to me, jLi {jaj nil oUS I ilil <ai-\ *»l i*iil filial *- Jui ilijf iLi <5 "VVTioewr felt satisfied, then Allah will enrich him. Whoever is modest, Allaii will make him decent. Whoever is content, then Allah will suffice for him . Whoever asks people, while having a small amout, he will have begged the people .» Abu Said said, "I said to myself, 1 have a camel, Al-Yaqutah, and indeed, it is worth more than a small amount.' And I went back without asking the Prophet for anything." This is the same wording for this Hadith collected by Abu Dawud and An- Nasa'iJ21 Allah's statement, iAnd whatever you spend in good, surely Allah knows it u>ell\$ indicates that no charity escapes Him, and He will reward it fully and perfectly on the Day of

Resurrection, when it is most desperately needed. Praise for those who spend in Charity Allah said, **“Those who spend their wealth (in Allah's cause) by night and day, in secret and in public, they shall have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve. This Ayah praises those who spend in charity for Allah's sake, seeking His pleasure, day and night, publicly and in secret, including what one spends on his family. The Two Ahmad 3 :9. * Abu Dawud 2 :279, An-Nasal 5 :95.**

SahVis recorded that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas: **“You will not spend/ charity with which you seek Allah's Face, but you will ascend a higher degree and status because of it, including what you put in your wife's mouth. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Mas'ud said that the Prophet ﷺ said, ‘If a Muslim spends on his family while awaiting the reward for it from Allah, it will be written as charity for him.’ Al-Bukhari and Muslim also recorded this Hadith. Allah said, ‘Those who spend in charity for Allah's sake, seeking His pleasure, day and night, publicly and in secret, including what one spends on his family. The Two Ahmad 3 :9. * Abu Dawud 2 :279, An-Nasal 5 :95.**

69 Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) obedience. We previously explained the Ayah, **“Those who eat Riba will not stand (on the Day of Resurrection) except like the standing of a person beaten by Shaytan leading him to insanity. That is because they say: ‘Trading is only like Riba,’ whereas Allah has permitted trading and forbidden Riba. So whosoever receives an admonition from his Lord and stops eating Riba, shall not be punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge); but whoever returns (to Riba), such are the dwellers of the Fire - they will abide therein. The Punishment for Dealing with Riba (Interest and Usury) After Allah mentioned the righteous believers who give charity, pay Zakah and spend on their relatives and families at various times and conditions, He then mentioned those who deal in usury and illegally acquire people's money, using various evil methods and wicked ways. Allah describes the condition of these people when they are resurrected from their graves and brought back to life on the Day of Resurrection: ‘Those who eat Riba will not stand (on the Day of Resurrection) except like the standing of a person beaten by Shaytan leading him to insanity.’ This Ayah means, on the Day of Resurrection, these people will get up from their graves just as the person afflicted by insanity or possessed by a demon would. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “On**

the Day of Resurrection, those who consume Riba will be

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 767–775]

71 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) Allah allow this, but did not allow that, they asked in defiance of Allah's commandments. Allah's statement, **“Whereas Allah has permitted trading and forbidden Riba”** might be a continuation of the answer to the disbelievers' claim, who uttered it, although they knew that Allah decided that ruling on trade is different from that of Riba. Indeed, Allah is the Most Knowledgeable, Most Wise, Whose decision is never resisted. Allah is never asked about what He does, while they will be asked. He is knowledgeable of the true reality of all things and the benefits they

carry. He knows what benefits His servants, so He allows it for them, and what harms them, so He forbids them from it. He is more merciful with them than the mother with her own infant. Thereafter, Allah said, 4/* J* V* Jji .juj J* ikgj iSo whosoever receives an admonition from his Lord and stops eating Riba, shall not be punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge),} meaning, those who have knowledge that Allah made usury unlawful, and refrain from indulging in it as soon as they acquire this knowledge, then Allah will forgive their previous dealings in Riba, Cf- lit &} iAllah has forgiven what is past.} On the day Makkah was conquered the Prophet jg said, *All cases of Riba during the time of Jdhiliyyah (pre-Islamic period of ignorance) is annulled and under my feet, and the first Riba I annul is the Riba of Al-'Abbds (the Prophet's uncle).*¹¹ We should mention that the Prophet jg did not require the |i| Abu Dawud 3 :628

return of the interest that they gained on their Riba during the time of Jahiliyyah. Rather, he pardoned the cases of Riba, that occurred in the past, just as Allah said, ^4) 'ij-A) '-it-' ?&} ishall not be punished for the past; his case is for Allah (to judge).} Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi said that, ishall not be punished for the past refers to the Riba one consumed before it was prohibited. 1 11 Allah then said, iBut whoever returns meaning, deals in Riba after gaining knowledge that Allah prohibited it, then that warrants punishment, and in this case, the proof will have been established against such person. This is why Allah said, isuch are the dwellers of the Fire - they will abide therein forever.} Abu Dawud recorded that Jabir said, “When u ‘fez ^a^ tiLk iThose who eat Riba will not stand (on the Day of Resurrection) except like a person beaten by Shaytan leading him to insanity) was revealed, the Messenger of Allah jg said, 4)1 Jjj-lj jjj —J Jv «Whoever does not refrain from Mukhabarah, then let him receive a notice ofwarfrom Allah and His Messengerj”¹² Al-Hakim also recorded this in his Mustadrakj³^ and he said, “It is Sahih according to the criteria of Muslim, and he did not record it.” Mukhabarah (sharecropping), farming land in return 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1135. I2 * Abu Dawud 3 : 695. 131 Al-Hakim 2:285.

73Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) for some of its produce, was prohibited. Muzabanah, trading fresh dates still on trees with dried dates already on the ground, was prohibited. Muhaqalah, which refers to trading produce not yet harvested, with crops already harvested, was also prohibited. These were prohibited to eradicate the possibility that Riba might be involved, for the quality and equity of such items are only known sifter they become dry. The subject of Riba is a difficult subject for many scholars. We should mention that the Leader of the Faithful, Umar bin Al-Khattab, said, “I wished that the Messenger of Allah sg had made three matters clearer for us, so that we could refer to his decision: the grandfather (regarding inheriting from his grandchildren), the Kalalah (those who leave neither descendants nor ascendants as heirs) and some types of Riba.’^ Umar was refering to the types of transactions where it is not clear whether they involve Riba or not. The Shari'ah supports the rule that for any matter that is unlawful, then the means to it are also unlafwful, because whatever results in the unlawful is unlawful, in the same way that whenever an obligation will not be complete except with something, then that something is itselfan obligation. The Two Sahihs recorded that An-Nu'man bin Bashir said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, I t Jiii olj cjln j. ^ J, ly’J ‘S-f iii-ii br- uBoth lawful and unlawful things are evident, but in between than there are matters that are not clear. So whoever saves himselffrom these unclear matters, he saves his religion and his honor. And whoever indulges in these unclear matters, he will have fallen into the prohibitions, just like a shepherd who

grazes (his animals) near a private pasture, at any moment he is liable to enter it.” The Sunan records that Al-Hasan bin ‘Ali said that he heard the Messenger of Allah sﷺ say, Fath Al-Bari 10 :48 , Muslim 4 :2322 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 : 153 , Muslim 3:1219.

V U Jj iL^; U jS» •Leave that which makes you doubt for that which does not make you doubt . (1 Ahmad recorded that Said bin Al-Musayyib said that Umar said, “The Ayah about Riba, was one of the last Ayat to be revealed, and the Messenger of Allah jg died before he explained it to us. So leave that which makes you doubt for that which does not make you doubt.”*2' Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, tRiba is seventy types, the least of which is equal to one having sexual intercourse with his mother. Continuing on the subject of prohibiting the means that lead to the unlawful, there is a Hadith that Ahmad recorded in which ‘A’ishah said, “When the Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah about Riba were revealed, the Messenger of Allah jg went out to the Masjid and recited them and also prohibited trading in alcohol. ”*4 ' The Six collections recorded this Hadith, with the exception of At-Tirmidhi.15 * The Two Sahihs recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, lJs\j ^ o_4Jl '4>\ ^j» «M«y Allah curse the Jews! Allah forbade them to eat animal fat, but they melted it and sold it, eating its price . »*6 ‘Ali and Ibn Maslid narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Aj-IALij aJSjAJ U^Jl ^S\ Ail! Jyjl) TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:221, An-Nasal 8 :328 * Ahmad 1 :36, Ibn Majah no. 2276. Ibn Majah 2:764, similar was recorded by Al-Hakim 2:37, and he said ‘It is Sahih according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs , but they did not record it." * Ahmad 6:46. 151 Fath. Al-Bari 8:51, Muslim 3:1206, Abu Dawud 3:759, An-Nasfil in Al-Kubra 6 :306 , Ibn Majah 2 :1 122. 161 Fath Al-Bari6 :572 , Muslim 1207.

75 Surah 2 . Al-Raqarah (Part-3) «May Allah curse whoever consumes Riba, whoever pays Riba, the two who are witnesses to it, and the scribe who records it.*" They say they only have witnesses and a scribe to write the Riba, contract when they want it to appear to be a legitimate agreement, but it is still invalid because the ruling is applied to the agreement itself, not the form that it appears in. Verily, deeds are judged by their intentions. * •>< 'y'. <.* <*"SZ\\ t£)? <276. will destroy Riba and will give increase for Sadaqdt. And Allah likes not the disbelievers, sinners .} <277. Truly, those who believe, and do deeds of righteousness, and perform the Saldh and give Zakdh, they will have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve. Allah Does Not Bless Riba Allah states that He destroys Riba, either by removing this money from those who eat it, or by depriving them of the blessing, and thus the benefit of their money. Because of their Riba, Allah will torment them in this life and punish them for it on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, <v4\$^ d&il jj sfA -i iSay: "Not equal are Al-Khabith (evil things) and At-Tayyib (good things), even though the abundance of Al-Khabith may please you"} (5:100) .A cl /Wf-njy iAnd put the wicked (disbelievers and doers of evil deeds) one over another, heap them together and cast them into Hell} [8:37], and, 111 Muslim 3:1219.

76 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr Xi ljjj> (jjlj " {And that which you give in gift (to others), in order that it may increase (your wealth by expecting to get a better one in return) from other people's property, has no increase with Allah} (30:39). Ibn Jarir said that Allah's statement, 4!S' I lit K" iAllah will destroy Riba} is similar to the statement reported of ‘Abdullah bin MasVid, uRiba will end up with less, even if it was substantial.” Imam Ahmad recorded a similar statement in Al-Musnad)2 Allah Increases Charity, Just as One Raises His Animal Allah's statement, iAtid will give increase for Sadaqdt } means, Allah makes

charity grow, or He increases it. Al- Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, ' ' V! 'Ij }-* i'jLj JjjL jjuij /Jo j4 >pi US p 1 -1-?vi 8Whoever gives in charity what equals a date from honest resources, and Allah only accepts that which is good and pure, then Allah accepts it with His right (Hand) and raises it far its giver, just as one of you raises his animal, until it becomes as big as a mountain This was recorded in the book of Zakah.[4] Allah Does not Like the Disbelieving Sinners Allah's statement, m At-Tabari 6:15. Ahmad 1 :395. [3] Fath Al-Bari 3 :326 , 13:426. Muslim 2 :702

ip\ 'if# 4-And Allah likes not the disbelievers, sinners indicates that Allah does not like he who has a disbelieving heart, who is a sinner in tongue and action. There is a connection between the beginning of the Ayah on Riba and

what Allah ended it with. Those who consume Riba are not

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 775–791]

satisfied with the permissible and pure resources that Allah provided them. Instead, they try to illegally acquire people's money by relying on evil methods. This demonstrates their lack of appreciation for the bounty that Allah provides. PraisingThoseWho Thank Allah Allah praised those who believe in His Lordship, obey His commands, thank Him and appreciate Him. They are those who are kind to His creation, establish prayer and give charity due on their money. Allah informed them of the honor that He has prepared for them and that they will be safe from the repercussions of the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, jU is is iTruly, those who believe, and do deeds of righteousness, and perform the Salah and give Zakah, they will have their reward with their Lord. On them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} p S*. Si Jy. £ !#•*' ij SjZliu V |^=qy1 J-/*j «if oi jl ”jA j£-»» dl ‘AA-* //“* jj ol) £ sl ^ jj, 4278. O yoM w/io believe! Have Taqwa of Allah and give up what retainsfrom Riba, ifyou are (really) believers .} 4279. And ifyou do not do it, then take a notice ofwarfrom Allah and His Messenger but ifyou repent, you shall have your capital sums. Deal not unjustly, and you shall not be dealt

with unjustly. 1280. And if the debtor is having a hard time, then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay; but ifyou remit it by way ofcharity, that is betterfor you ifyou did but know> 1281. And have Taqwa the Day when you shall be brought back to Allah . Then every person shall be paid what he earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustly. The Necessity of TaqwaandAvoiding Riba Allah commands His believing servants to fear Him and warns them against what would bring them closer to His anger and drive them away from His pleasure. Allah said, 4* Qejf iO you who believe! Have Taqwa ofAllah} meaning, fear Him and remember that He is watching all that you do. 45^ he jji £ (j iAnd give up what remains of Riba} meaning, abandon the Riba that people still owe you upon hearing this warning, <£#& fUr& iifyou indeed have been believers} believing in the trade that He allowed you and the prohibition of Riba. Zayd bin Aslam, Ibn Jurayj, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As-Suddi said that this Ayah was revealed about Bani ‘Amr bin ‘Umayr, a sub-tribe of Thaqlf, and Bani Al-Mughlah, from the tribe of Bani Makhzum, between whom were outstanding transactions of Riba leftover from time of Jahiliyyah. When Islam came and both tribes became Muslims, Thaqlf required Bam Al-Mughlah to pay the Riba of that transaction, but Bani Al-Mughlah said, “We do not pay Riba in Islam.” ‘Attab bin Usayd, the Prophet's deputy on Makkah, wrote to the Messenger of Allah jg about this matter. This

Ayah was then revealed and the Messenger of Allah jg conveyed it to ‘Attab, 1A2 \$4 4 g c & fjsi \pa Qi} jif bt lyjfe

79Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) 40 you who believe! Be afraid of Allah and give up what remains (due to you) from Riba (from now onward), if you are (really) believers. And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger.} They said, “We repent to Allah and abandon whatever is left of our Riba”, and they all abandoned it This Ayah serves as a stern threat to those who continue to deal in Riba after Allah revealed this warning. Riba Constitutes War Against Allah and His Messenger Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, 4then take a notice of war means, “Be sure of a war from Allah and His Messenger.”*2 ' He also said, “On the Day of Resurrection, those who eat Riba will be told, “take up arms for war.”” He then recited, 4And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger.^*3 ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said about, Jt iyifc LA** oft 4And if you do not do it, then take a notice of war from Allah and His Messenger,} “Whoever kept dealing with Riba and did not refrain from it, then the Muslim Leader should require him to repent. If he still did not refrain from Riba, the Muslim Leader should cut off his head.”*4 Allah then said, 4But if you repent, you shall have your capital sums. Deal not unjustly} **** Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1 140,1 141 . This story is not authentic. 121 At-Jabari 6 :26 131 At-Tabari 6:25. * At-Tabari 6:25.

by taking the Riba, %} iAnd you shall not be dealt with unjustly meaning, your original capital will not diminish. Rather, you will receive only what you lent without increase or decrease. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Amr bin Al-Ahwas said, “The Messenger of Allah jg gave a speech during the Farewell Hajj saying; jA Xs- \jj Lj Jj\j tj voi. :::\j j *Verily, every case of Riba from the Jdhiliyyah is completely annulled. You will only take back your capital, without increase or decrease. The first Riba that 1 annul is the Riba of AWAbbas bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, all of it is annulledJ111 Being Kind to Debtors Who Face Financial Difficulties Allah said, 'jy iyii Jj YJ-Ya d! jS-* j TA*. iAnd if the debtor is having a hard time, then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay; but if you remit it by way of charity, that is better for you if you did but know.} Allah commands creditors to be patient with debtors who are having a hard time financially, 3', j£} iAnd if the debtor is having a hard time (lias no money), then grant him time till it is easy for him to repay.} During the time of Jdhiliyyah, when the debt came to term, the creditor would say to the debtor, “Either pay now or interest will be added to the debt.” Allah encouraged creditors to give debtors respite regarding their debts and promised all that is good, and a great reward Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1147.

81Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3J from Him for this righteous deed, 'jUS jj, jf- iBut if you remit it by way of charity, that is better for you if you did but know meaning, if you forfeit your debts and cancel them completely. Imam Ahmad recorded that Sulayman bin Buraydah said that his father said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, oiiJLi dl* di i. 'jui\ ^Whoever gives time to a debtor facing hard times, will gain charity of equal proportions for each day he gives . I also heard the Prophet jg say, dtt di 'jaj\ yt 'Whoever gives time to a debtor facing hard times, will earn charity multiplied two times for each day he gives. I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! I heard you say, Whoever gives time to a debtor facing hard times, will gain charity of equal proportions for each day he gives.’ I also heard you say, Whoever gives time to a debtor facing hard times, will earn charity multiplied by two times for each day he gives.’ He sg said, f*i di y df Jj dL d” d-Ld> o'Al aHe will earn charity of equal proportions for each day (lie gives

it down directs Allah's believing servants to record their business transactions when their term is delayed, to preserve the terms and timing of these transactions, and the memory of witnesses, as mentioned at the end of the Ayah, -51 0j&& {ft\$ ie pf} ithat is more just with Allah; more solid as evidence, and more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves.} The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah's Messenger came to Al-Madinah, while the people were in the habit of paying in advance for fruits to be delivered within one or two years. The Messenger of Allah jg said, JI Ojjj ^ * * » * "Whoever pays money in advance (jbr dates to be delivered later) should pay it Jbr known specified measure and weight (of the dates) for a specified date .»121 Allah's statement, At-Tabari 6:41 Fath Al-Bari 4: 105, Muslim 3:1226.

87Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) ^Whoever kept knowledge to himself will be restrained by a bridle made offire on the Day ofResurrectionV Mujahid and 'Ata' said that if asked to do so, "The scribe is required to record." Allah's statement, iS 4 ilet him (the debtor) who incurs the liability dictate, and he must have Taqwa ofAllah, his Lord> indicates that the debtor should dictate to the scribe what he owes, so let him fear Allah, 4And diminish not anything ofwhat he owes,'} meaning, not hide any portion ofwhat he owes. 4But if the debtor is ofpoor understanding} and is not allowed to decide on such matters, because he used to waste money, for instance, 40r weak}, such as being too young or insane, 40r is unable to dictate for himself} because of a disease, or ignorance about such matters, 4then let his guardian dictate in justice.} Witnesses Should Attend the Dictation ofContracts Allah said, 4And get two witnesses out ofyour own men} requiring witnesses to attend the dictation of contracts to m At-Tabarani 5:11.

further preserve the contents, &&p ofr 4Attd if there are not tioo men (available), then a man and two women } this requirement is only for contracts that directly or indirectly involve money. Allah requires that two women take the place of one man as witness, because of the woman's shortcomings, as the Prophet jg described. Muslim recorded in his Sahih that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger ofAllah ig said, «0 women 1 . Gwe away charity and ask for forgiveness, for I saw that you comprise the majority of the people of the Fire.o One eloquent woman said, "O Messenger of Allah! Why do we comprise the majority of the people of the Fire?" He said, jJu-i 3j jit oLiiu o-j i j i>j ~«J i j'jisSj "You curse a lot and you do not appreciate your mate. I have never seen those who have shortcoming in mind and religion controlling those who have sound minds, other than youJ She said, "O Messenger of Allah! What is this shortcoming in mind and religion?" He jg said, <1)LMi 1 «As for the shortcoming in her mind, the testimony of two women equals the testimony of one man, and this is the shortcoming in the mind. As for the shortcoming in the religion, woman remains for nights at a time when she does not pray and breaks the fast in Ramadan^ Allah's statement, icn isuch as you agree for witnesses} requires competency in the m Muslim 1 :87.

89Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) witnesses. Further, Allah's statement, icL&Q J-*; J} iso that if one of them errs} refers to the two women witnesses; whenever one ofthem forgets a part of the testimony, ithe other can remind her meaning, the other woman's testimony mends the shortcoming of forgetfulness in the first woman. Allah's statement, 4s> c &&d %} iAnd the witnesses should not refuse when they are called means, when people are called to be witnesses, they should agree, as Qatadah and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas stated. Similarly, Allah said, LE=* LisS d Yj} iLet not the scribe refuse to write as Allah has

taught him, so let him write.} Some say that this Ayah indicates that agreeing to become a witness is Fard Kifayah (required on at least a part of the Muslim Ummah). However, the majority of the scholars say that the Ayah, 4d £ 4 iesiifd i;} iAnd the witnesses should not refuse when they are called} is referring to testifying to what the witnesses actually witnessed,' thus befitting their description of being witnesses'. Therefore, when the witness is called to testify to what he witnessed, he is required to give testimony, unless this obligation was already fulfilled, in which case such testimony becomes Fard Kifayah. Mujahid and Abu Mijlaz said, "If you Eire csilled to be a witness, then you have the choice to agree. If you witnessed and were called to testify, then come fonvEU-d."21 It was reported that Ibn 'Abbas and Al- At-Tabari 6:68. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1181, At-Tabari 6:71.

Hasan Al-Basri said that the obligation includes both cases, agreeing to be a witness and testifying to what one witnessed. Allah's statement, 4You should not become weary to write it (your contract), whether it be small or large, for its fixed term} perfects this direction from Allah by commanding that the debt be written, whether the amount is large or small. Allah said, 4You should not become weary} meaning, do not be discouraged against writing transactions and their terms, whether the amount involved is large or small. Allah's statement, pis jif x* J£ifpt} 4that is more just with Allah; more solid as evidence, and more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves} means, writing transactions that will be fulfilled at a later date is more just with Allah meaning better and more convenient in order to preserve the terms of the contract. Therefore, recording such agreements helps the witnesses, when they see their handwriting - or signatures - later on and thus remember what they witnessed, for it is possible that the witnesses might forget what they witnessed. 4And more convenient to prevent doubts among yourselves} meaning, this helps repel any doubt. Since if you need to refer to the contract that you wrote and the doubt will end. Allah's statement, kZ/jA ul 4save when it is a present trade which you carry out on the spot among yourselves, then there is no sin on you if you do not write it down} indicates that if the transaction will be fulfilled immediately, then there is no harm if it is not recorded.

91Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) As for requiring witnesses to be present in trading transactions, Allah said, iBut take witnesses whenever you make a commercial contract. However, this command was abrogated by, iPkS jJ}f ;£S {Then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust (faithfully).} Or, it could be that having witnesses in such cases is only recommended and not obligatory, as evident from the Hadith that Khuzaymah bin Thabit Al-Ansari narrated which Imam Ahmad collected. Umarah bin Khuzaymah Al-Ansari said that his uncle, who was among the Prophet's Companions, told him that the Prophet jg was making a deal for a horse with a bedouin man. The Prophet 2§ asked the bedouin to follow him so that he could pay him the price of the horse. The Prophet jg went ahead of the bedouin. The bedouin met several men who tried to buy his horse, not knowing if the Prophet jg was actually determined to buy it. Some people offered more money for the horse than the Prophet sg had. The bedouin man said to the Prophet jg, "Ifyou want to buy this horse, then buy it or I will sell it to someone else." When he heard the bedouin man's words, the Prophet fg stood up and said, "Have I not bought that horse from you?" The bedouin said, "By Allah! I have not sold it to you." The Prophet jg said, "Rather, I did buy it from you." The people gathered around the Prophet jg and the Bedouin while they were disputing, and the bedouin said, "Bring forth a witness who testifies that I sold you the horse." Meanwhile, the Muslims who came said to the bedouin, "Woe to you! The Prophet only says the truth." When Khuzaymah bin Thabit came and heard the dispute between the Prophet sg and

the bedouin who was saying, “Bring forth a witness who testifies that I sold you the horse,” Khuzaymah said, “I bear witness that you sold him the horse.” The Prophet ^{sg} said to Khuzaymah, “What is the basis of your testimony?” Khuzaymah said, “That I entrusted you, O Messenger of Allah!” Therefore, the Messenger ^{jg} made Khuzaymah’s testimony

93Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) jr 1 Y> IS / -f-' *> •}, o!j' / i ^ •/ ^ y .^r A** J| v/. y. i • / c£jl^ Lva*j 0^ ^ s' “tit \ >>2* t*"-! yA \a \ ^-=^> ftjQ o£3'4^' (^^ o_ji_>c3y' 'jJ-HOij l^jV'(4^*J <a^:- SpA0ff^dp\pp^<^<AAk3 C-k—i\$TU c-o—L«LgJ j^1,1—X>4}> Ky j'-j'a^'-zzW^ylj\) ^C-U j>_..rt'>\iU—4>*—“ Messenger, He will give you a double portion of His mercy, and He will give you a light by which you shall walk (straight)} [57:28]. Allah said; 4And Allah is the All-Knower of everything} stating that Allah has perfect knowledge in all matters and in their benefits or repercussions, and nothing escapes His perfect watch, for His knowledge encompasses everything in existence. ft f- &m 0{S V “ s ft' ' ,s.& ! > <o> 0*4^ u-*jt '-*® rylu> y; \h\ j&^ fc -it pj pf 4' gE pA. A i%%£ ZE2 £f ifcH ^233. And if you are on a journey and cannot find a scribe, then let there be a pledge taken (mortgaging), then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust, and let him have Taqwa of Allah, his Lord. And conceal not the evidence, for he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful And Allah is All-Knower of what you do.}

What is the 'Mortgaging' Mentioned in the Ayah?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 791–803]

iAttd if you are on a journey} meaning, traveling and some of you borrowed some money to be paid at a later date, i&x p;} iand cannot find a scribe who would record the debt for you. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “And even if they find a scribe, but did not find paper, ink or pen.” Then, 0“ let there be a pledge taken (mortgaging)} given to the creditor in lieu of writing the transaction. The Two Sahihs recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah ^{jg} died while his shield was mortgaged with a Jew in return for thirty Wasq (approximately 180 kg) of barley, which the Prophet ^{jg} bought on credit as provisions for his household. In another narration, the Hadith stated that this Jew was among the Jews of Al-Madīnah.' Allah said, jjl ffi 4then if one of you entrusts the other, let the one who is entrusted discharge his trust (faithfully) .} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded, with a sound chain of narration, that Abu Saïd Al-Khudri said, “This Ayah abrogated what came before it (i.e. that which required recording the transaction and having witnesses present).”² Ash-Sha‘bi said, “If you trust each other, then there is no harm if you do not write the loan or have witnesses present.”³ Allah’s statement, 4And let him have Taqwa of Allah means, the debtor. Imam Ahmad and the Sunnm recorded that Qatadah said that Al-Hasan said that Samurah said that the Messenger of Allah ^{jg} said, Fath Al-B&ri⁴ :354 , Muslim 3:1226. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1202. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :1203

nThe hand (of the debtor) will carry the burden of what it took until it gives it back. b111 Allah’s statement, iAttd conceal not the evidence> means, do not hide it or refuse to announce it. Ibn ‘Abbas and other scholars said, “False testimony is one of the worst of the major sins, and such is the case with hiding the true testimony. This is why Allah said, 4For he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful As-Suddi commented, “Meaning he is a sinner in his heart.”²¹ This is similar to Allah’s statement, -J4 4U ^ iWe shall not hide testimony of Allah, for then indeed we should be of the sinful (5:106]. Allah said, f

if- fS lyb ojj ol ±4\ *3 fez "% Up if <ili f oj, otpVb 4 o «*& Si' ijj* 9 <0 yow who believe! Stand out firmly for justice, as witnesses to Allah, even though it be against yourselves, or your parents, or your kin, be he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both (than you). So follow not the lusts (of your hearts), lest you avoid justice; and if you distort your witness or refuse to give it, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do> [4:135] and in this Ayah (2:283] He said, 111 Ahmad 5:13, Abu Dawud 3:822, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:482, An- Nasal in Al-Kubru 3 :41 1 , Ibn Majah 2 :802 121 At-Jabari 6:100.

iUf 'o&z tL% p: »i3j£ k^hi ^y \$And conceal not the evidence, for he who hides it, surely, his heart is sinful. And Allah is All-Knower of what you do.y '<it 4* f p=Lp\ ii u ijlj jij 4 Cj oJ2£l' 4 li <2^ 4 /A_J * A^TCB* «*>' J *t£li jV» _J *L£j /vJ 4284. To Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and whether you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah will call you to account for it. Then He forgives whom He wills and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is able to do all things. Would the Servants be Accountable for What They Conceal in Their Hearts? Allah states that His is the kingship of the heavens and earth and of what and whoever is on or between them, that He has perfect watch over them. No apparent matter or secret that the heart conceals is ever a secret to Him, however minor it is. Allah also states that He will hold His servants accountable for what they do and what they conceal in their hearts. In similar statements, Allah said, (•'-y ^X j£=>& iSay (O Multammad : "Whether you hide what is in your breasts or reveal it, Allah knows it, and He knows what is in the heavens and what is in the earth. And Allah is able to do all things [3:29], and, iHe knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden. There are many other Ayat on this subject. In this Ayah [2:284], Allah states that He has knowledge of what the hearts conceal, and consequently, He will hold the creation accountable for whatever is in their hearts. This is why when this Ayah was revealed, it was hard on the Companions, since out of their strong faith and conviction, they were afraid that

97Surah 2. Al-Baqarah (Part-3) such reckoning would diminish their good deeds. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "When * (Xu-Wj A '4 t* ij-uj jjj 4 4 U J^=* £ ii'S its£ 4-iSS fs >JS 4To Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and whether you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah ivill call you to account far it. Then He forgives whom He zvills and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is able to do all things} was revealed to the Messenger of Allah jg, it was very hard for the Companions of the Messenger s^ . The Companions came to the Messenger and fell to their knees saying, 'O Messenger of Allah! We were asked to perform what we can bear of deeds: the prayer, the fast, Jihad and charity. However, this Ayah was revealed to you, and we cannot bear it.' The Messenger ofAllah jg said, j? jit Jli US' \ljc jt jjjyju *Do you want to repeat what the People of the Two Scriptures before you said, that is, 'We hear and we disobey?' Rather, say, 'We hear and toe obey, and we seek Your forgiveness, O our Lord, and the Return is to You .» When the people accepted this statement and their tongues recited it, Allah sent down afterwards, •jy 'ifal fat <>*** 'fa oyfafafaj '<jj ot 4 ™. faxij Cfa cTiiJue- Lijjtj tLi. 'jJVSjj Vi jfa' oft YjC 4The Messenger believes in what has been sent down to himfrom his Lord, and (so do)the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between one another ofHis Messengers" - and they say, "We hear, and we obey. (We seek) Your forgiveness, our Lord, and to You is the return (ofall)."} When they did that, Allah abrogated the Ayah [2:284] and sent down the Ayah,

o). V C.j e. ' U ^c-j C4^ U \-|J * -j l jj iil - 'fj 4&LZ } \$Allah burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reiuard far that (good) which he has earned, and he is punisliedfar that (evil) which he has earned. "Our Lord! Punish us not if we forget orfall into error."} until the end." Muslim recorded it with the wording; "When they did that, Allah abrogated it [2:284] and sent down, 4 v Cj^3 3S3T cO yi3 if J&i iS13 4Allah burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reivard far that (good) which he has earned, and he is punishedfar that (evil) which he has earned. "Our Lord! Punish us not if we forget orfall into error".} Allah said, 'I shall (accept your supplication),' ^ULi 3 (S % £££ 4"Our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (Jeivs and Christians)" } Allah said, 'I shall (accept your supplication),' 03^3 **;% } 4"Our Lord! Put not on us a burden greater than we have strength to bear." } Allah said, 1 shall (accept your supplication),' CJji3 t^fj ii)ii;& ±i\j } 4"Pardon us and grant us forgiveness. Have mercy on us. You are our Mawla (Supporter and Protector) and give us victory over the disbelieving people." } Allah said, 1 shall.' "12 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Mujahid said, "I saw Ibn 'Abbas and said to him, 'O Abu Abbas! I was with Ibn 'Umar, and he 111 Ahmad 2:412. Muslim 1:115.

99Siirah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) read this Ayah and cried.' He asked, Which Ayah?' I said, ^ '4 L* ijil; '\$And whether you disclose zohat is in yourselves or conceal it.y Ibn 'Abbas said, When this Ayah was revealed, it was very hard on the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ag and worried them tremendously. They said: O Messenger of Allah! We know that we would be punished according to our statements and our actions, but as for what occurs in our hearts, we do not control what is in them.' The Messenger of Allah^ said, a I » l « o .. : \jl «Say , 'We hear and toe obey They said, We hear and we obey.' Thereafter, this Ayah abrogated the previous Ayah, iThe Messenger believes in what has been sent doivn to him from his Lord , and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah}, until, c licr c^ tjcj vi iii iif i v> iAII dh burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reivard for that (good) which he has earned, and he is punishedfor that (evil) which he has earned.} Therefore, they were pardoned what happens in their hearts, and were held accountable only for their actions.'" The Group recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, j\ ^ *4 i: - . l "Allah has pardoned my Ummah for ivhat they say to themselves, as long as they do not utter it or act on tf.» 2 ' [1 * Ahmad 1 :332. * Fath Al-Bari 9:300, Muslim 1 :1 17, Abu Dawud 2:657, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 4:361 , An-Nasal 6:156, Ibn Majah 1 :658.

100 Tafoir tbn Kathir The Two Sahihs recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, lilj liili Ufo&s 'fi jillj lij :i)l Jli' 1 1 t&j^S\j IfLp jLi i U "Allah said (to His angels), "IfMy servant intnds to commit an evil deed, do not record it as such for him, and if he commits it, write it for him as one evil deed. If he intends to perform a good deed, but did not perform it, then write it for him as one good deed, and ifhe performs it, write it for him as ten good deeds ."[11 4j* <<SJ ,>*b^ V } ^,jmJ l — iXJjj Vj-j ..?4i 1 J L. «»-»<> yL-JJ <3 V •> qj V L>5 Co—iSt U U I4J l^wj 1—*> 4jiil — •2; g; uu « <2^ t_& jjs *; £5 'fidiS \$ d* tjwiiU \J yli-1 J lit • ij IJ 43U0 U 4285. The Messenger believes in what has been sent down to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. Each one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between one another of His Messengers" - and they say, "We hear, and we obey. (We seek) Your forgiveness, our Lord, and to You is the return (of all).") i286. Allah burdens not a person beyond his scope. He gets reward for that (good) which he has earned, and he is punished for that (evil) which he has earned. "Our Lord! Punish

us not if we forget or fall into error, our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (Jews and Christians); our Lord! Put not on us a burden greater than we have strength to bear. Pardon us and grant us forgiveness. Have mercy on us. You are our Mawld (Patron, Supporter and Protector) and give us victory over the disbelieving people.") m Fath Al-B&ri 13 :473, Muslim 1:117.

101 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) The HadiihsontheVirtue ofTheseTwo Ayat,MayAllah BenefitUsbyThem Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, lillJ ^ ij£)\ Ir*" «Whoever recites the last tzvo Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah at night, they ivill sufficefor him." The rest of the six also recorded similar wording for this Hadith.'2 ' The Two Sahihs recorded this Hadith using various chains of narration,13 ' and Imam Ahmad also recorded it.' 4' Muslim recorded that 'Abdullah said, "When the Messenger of Allah 3g§ went on the Isra journey, he ascended to the Sidrat Al-Muntaha 's ' in the sixth heaven, where whatever ascends from the earth ends at, and whatever descends from above it ends at. iWheti that covered the lote tree which did cover it!} [53:16] meaning, a mat made of gold. The Messenger of Allah jg was then given three things: the five prayers, the last Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah and forgiveness for whoever did not associate anything or anyone with Allah from his Ifmmah."6' Earlier we mentioned the Hadith regarding the virtues of Surat Al-Fatihah from Ibn 'Abbas which stated, "While the Messenger of Allah jg was with Jibril, he heard a noise from above. Jibfil lifted his sight to the sky and said, This is a door that was opened just now in heaven, and it was never opened before.'An angel came down through the door to the Prophet and said, "Receive the good news of two lights that you have m Fath Al-Bari 8 :672 ' Muslim 1:555, Abu Dawud 2:118, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :188, An- Nas&l in Al-Kubr& 5 : 14 , Ibn Majah 1 :435 3| Fath Al-Bari 8 :712 , 7 :369 , Muslim 1 :554 ' Ahmad 4:118. ' Lote-tree ofthe utmost boundary, beyond which none can pass. 161 Muslim 1:157.

202 Tafslr Ibn Kathir been given and which no Prophet before you was given: the Opener of the Book (Al-Fatihah) and the last Ayat in Surat Al- Baqarah. You will not read a letter of them, but you will be granted its benefit.'” This Hadlth was collected by Muslim and An-Nasa’i, 1 11 and this is the wording collected by An-Nasal. The Tafsir ofthe Last Two Ayat of SuratAl-Baqarah Allah said, it . > i - '\ s'-aV— j & iEach one believes in Allah, His Angels, His Books, and His Messengers. (They say,) "We make no distinction between one another of His Messengers . "\$> Therefore, each of the believers believes that Allah is the One and Only and the Sustainer, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and there is no Lord except Him. The believers also believe in all Allah’s Prophets and Messengers, in the Books that were revealed from heaven to the Messengers and Prophets, who are indeed the servants of Allah. Further, the believers do not differentiate between any of the Prophets, such as, believing in some of them and rejecting others. Rather, all of Allah’s Prophets and Messengers are, to the believers, truthful, righteous, and they were each guided to the path of righteousness, even when some of them bring what abrogates the Law of some others by Allah’s leave. Later on, the Law of Muhammad, the Final Prophet and Messenger from Allah, abrogated all the laws of the Prophets before him. So the Last Hour will commence while Muhammad’s Law remains the only valid Law, and all the while a group of his Ummah will always be on the path of truth, apparent and dominant. Allah’s statement, 4 Lutlj LILL iAnd they say, "I've hear, and we obey"} means, we heard Your statement, O our Lord, comprehended and implemented it, and adhered to its implications. 4(We seek) Your forgiveness, our Lord^ contains a plea and Muslim 1 :554, An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubra 5:12.

103 Surah 2 . Al-Baqarah (Part-3) supplication for Allah's forgiveness, mercy and kindness. Allah's statement, 4^j -fy C_i 'it v} iAllah burdens not a person beyond his scope} means, Allah does not ask a soul what is beyond its ability. This only demonstrates Allah's kindness, compassion and generosity towards His creation. This Ayah is the Ayah that abrogated the Ayah that worried the Companions, that is, Allah's statement, 4 •A-**3 A "4 U 'jjI; 4And ivltether you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah zoill call you to accountfor it.} This indicates that although Allah will question His servants and judge them, He will only punish for what one is able to protect himself from. As for what one cannot protect himself from, such as what one says to himself - or passing thoughts - they will not be punished for that. We should state here that to dislike the evil thoughts that cross one's mind is a part of faith. Allah said next, 4iZ% £<^} 4He gets reioardfor that ivltich he has earned} of good, 4 £ ty&j} 4And he is punished for that which he has earned} of evil, that is, concerning the acts that one is responsible for. Allah then said, [mentioning what the believers said] while directing His servants to supplicate to Him, all the while promising them that He will answer their supplication: 4"Our Lord! Push us not ifweforget or fall into error,"} meaning, "If we forgot an obligation or fell into a prohibition, or made an error while ignorant of its ruling." We mentioned the Hadith by Abu Hurayrah, that Muslim collected, wherein Allah said, "I shall (accept your supplication)." There is also the Hadith by Ibn 'Abbas that Allah said, "I did (accept your hi Muslim 1:115.

supplication)." 1 ' 4^* ij^- /oi^» ViJ* J-io Yj 4Our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (fews and Christians),} means, "Even if we were able to perform them, do not require us to perform the difficult deeds as You required the previous nations before us, such as the burdens that were placed on them. You sent Your Prophet Muhammad sg, the Prophet of mercy, to abrogate these burdens through the Law that You revealed to him, the Hanifi (Islamic Monotheism), easy religion." Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said that Allah said, "I shall (accept your supplication). ""2 ' Ibn 'Abbas narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said that Allah said, "I did (accept your supplication).""3 ' There is the Hadith recorded through various chains of narration that the Messenger of Allah sg said, «I ivas sent with the easy Hanifiyyah wayjW i** Q ijUi 'Z £ H&g Zj (%,) iOur Lord! Put not on us a burden greater than roe have strength to bear} of obligations, hardships and afflictions, do not make us bear what we cannot bear of this. 4-* u C C&m Vj ££} iOur Lord! Pul not on us a burden greater than we have strength to bear.} We mentioned that Allah said, "I shall (accept your supplication)""5 ' in one narration, and, "I did (accept your supplication)," in another narration. * J ' Muslim 1 :1 16. Muslim 1 : 1 15 ' Muslim 1 :116. ' Ahmad 5:266, 6:116,233. These are references for similar wordings . The first is also recorded by Al-Humaydi , see As-Sahihah ' Ibn Abi Hatim 3:1235.

i'Chk JI&\ iPardon us meaning, between us and You regarding what You know ofour shortcomings and errors. iAnd grant us forgiveness \$> concerning what is between us and Your servants. Sodo notexposeour errorsand evildeeds tothem. iHave merey on us} in what will come thereafter. Therefore, do not allow us to fall into another error. They say that those who commit error need three things: Allah's forgiveness for what is between Him and them, that He conceals these errors from His other servants, and thus does not expose them before the servants, and that He grants them immunity from further error." We mentioned before that Allah answered these pleas, "I shall," in one narration and, "I did," in another narration. ^Yow are our Mawld^ meaning. You are our supporter and helper, our trust is

in You, You are sought for each and every type of help and our total reliance is on You. There is no power or strength except from You. sji iAnd give us victory over the disbelieving people^ those who rejected Your religion, denied Your Oneness, refused the Message of Your Prophet jg, worshipped other than You and associated others in Your worship. Give us victory and make us prevail above them in this and the Hereafter. Allah said, "I shall," in one narration, and, "I did," in the Hadith that Muslim collected from Ibn 'Abbas. Further, Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Ishaq said that whenever Mu'adh would finish reciting this Surah, iAnd give us victory over the disbelieving people}, he would say "Amin." m At-Tabari 6 : 146

Surah 3: Al-Imran

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 804–814]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Al 'Imran (Chapter 3) Surah Al 'Imran was revealed in Al-Madinah, as evident by the fact that the first eighty-three Ayat in it relate to the delegation from Najran that arrived in Al-Madinah on the ninth year of Hijrah (632 CE). We will elaborate on this subject when we explain the Ayah about the Mubahalah [3:61] in this Surah, Allah willing. We should also state that we mentioned the virtues of Surah Al 'Imran along with the virtues of Surat Al-Baqara in the beginning of the

Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. g. c# 0 gJi 1SEii Jig £ I ill j* iJj V at MJ oUyi' ifii Ji irt .i f . » ' > { ' » < ® "?! > • < **5' JJ • **!> V'- </n t/ie Name o/Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful} 41. Alif-Lam-Mim .} 42. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the

2OS Tafsir Ibn Kathir Ever Living, the One Wfzo sustains and protects all that exists.} 43. It is He Who has sent down the Book to you with truth, confirming what came before it. And He sent down the Tawrdh and the Injil,} 44. Aforetime, as a guidance to mankind. And He sent down the criterion. Truly, those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah, for them there is a severe torment; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution .} We mentioned the Hadith in the Tafsir of Ayat Al-Kursi [2:255] that mentions that Allah's Greatest Name is contained in these two Ayat, tfii *}[H 4Alldlt! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Wlw sustains and protects all that exists and, 4 . (iP V <i! ; 4Alif-Ldm-Mim . Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Ever Living, the One Wlto sustains and protects all that exists.} We also explained the Tafsir of, 4^} 4Alif-Lam-Mim} in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah, and the meaning of, 'fi Vt, "V 4Alldh! La ilaha ilia Huwa, Al-Hayyul-Qayyum in the Tafsir of Ayat Al-Kursi. Allah's statement, 4&& C&J' %} 4It is He Who has sent down the Book to you with truth,} means, revealed the Qur'an to you, O Muhammad, in truth, meaning there is no doubt or suspicion that it is revealed from Allah. Verily, Allah revealed the Qur'an with His knowledge, and the angels testify to this fact, Allah is sufficient as a Witness. Allah's statement,

^Aj 4Confirming what came before it)> means, from the previous divinely revealed Books, sent to the servants and Prophets of Allah. These Books testify to the truth of the Qur'an, and the Qur'an also testifies to the truth these Books contained, including the news and glad tidings of Muhammad's prophethood and the revelation of the Glorious Qur'an. Allah said, 4And He sent down the Tawrah> to Musa (Musa) son of Imran, 4And the Injil\$, to Isa, son of Mary, 4& Jit ^Aforetime} meaning, before the Qur'an was revealed, 4As a guidance to mankind> in their time. it&sm 4And He sent down the criterion£ which is the distinction between misguidance, falsehood and deviation on one hand, and

guidance, truth and piety on the other hand. This is because of the indications, signs, plain evidences and clear proofs that it contains, and because of its explanations, clarifications, etc. Allah's statement, 'Truly, those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah' means they denied, refused and unjustly rejected them, 'For them there is a severe torment' on the Day of Resurrection,

no Tafsir Ibtī Katlur 'And Allah is All-Mighty meaning, His grandeur is invincible and His sovereignty is infinite. 'All-Able of Retribution' from those who reject His Ayat and defy His honorable Messengers and great Prophets. 'Nothing is hidden from Allah, in the earth or in the heaven.' A6. He it is Who shapes you in the wombs as He wills. None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Almighty, the All-Wise.' Allah states that He has perfect knowledge in the heavens and earth and that nothing in them is hidden from His watch. 'He it is Who shapes you in the wombs as He wills.' meaning, He creates you in the wombs as He wills, whether male or female, handsome or otherwise, happy or miserable. 'None has the right to be worshipped but He), the Almighty, the All-Wise.' meaning, He is the Creator and thus is the only deity worthy of worship, without partners, and His is the perfect might, wisdom and decision. This Ayah refers to the fact that Isa, son of Mary, is a created servant, just as Allah created the rest of mankind. Allah created 'Isa in the womb (of his mother) and shaped him as He willed. Therefore, how could Isa be divine, as the Christians, may Allah's curses descend on them, claim? 'Isa was created in the womb and his creation changed from stage to stage, just as Allah said, 'He creates you in the wombs of your mothers, creation after

creation in three veils of darkness.' [39:6]. 'It is He Who has sent down to you the Book. In it are verses that are entirely clear, they are the foundations of the Book; and others not entirely clear. So as for those in whose hearts there is a deviation (from the truth) they follow (only) that which is not entirely clear thereof, seeking Al-Fitnah, and seeking its Ta'wil, but none knows its Ta'wil except Allah. And those who are firmly grounded in knowledge say: "We believe in it; all of it is from our Lord." And none receive admonition except men of understanding.' (They say): "Our Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly, You are the Bestower."} 49. "Our Lord! Verily, it is You Who will gather mankind together on the Day about which there is no doubt. Verily, Allah never breaks His Promise."} The Mutashabihat and Muhkam Ayat Allah states that in the Qur'an, there are Ayat that are Muhkam, entirely clear and plain, and these are the foundations of the Book which are plain for everyone. And there are Ayat in the Qur'an that are Mutashabihat not entirely clear for many, or some people. So those who refer to the Muhkam Ayat to understand the Mutashabihat Ayat, will have acquired the correct guidance, and vice versa. This is why Allah said, 'They are the foundations of the Book', meaning, they are the basis of the Qur'an, and should be referred to for clarification, when warranted,

And others not entirely clear as they have several meanings, some that agree with the Muhkam and some that carry other literal indications, although these meaning might not be desired. The Muhkam are the Ayat that explain the abrogating rulings, the allowed, prohibited, laws, limits, obligations and rulings that should be believed in and implemented. As for the Mutashabihat

Ayat they include the abrogated Ayat, parables, oaths, and what should be believed in, but not implemented. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar commented on, cSX. iL} ihi it are verses that are entirely clear} as “Containing proof of the Lord, immunity for the servants and a refutation of opponents and of falsehood. They cannot be changed or altered from what they were meant for.” He also said, “As for the unclear Ayat, they can (but must not) be altered and changed, and this is a test from Allah to the servants, just as He tested them with the allowed and prohibited things. So these Aydt must not be altered to imply a false meaning or be distorted from the truth.” Therefore, Allah said, iSo asfor those in whose hearts there is a deviation} meaning, those who are misguided and deviate from truth to falsehood, 4-lii U ithey follow that which is not entirely clear thereof} meaning, they refer to the Mutashdbih, because they are able to alter its meanings to conform with their false interpretation since the wordings of the Mutashabihat encompass such a wide area of meanings. As for the Muhkam Aydt, they cannot be altered because they are clear and, thus, constitute unequivocal proof against the misguided people. This is why Allah said, filial &#} ^seeking Al-Fitnah} meaning, they seek to misguide their following by pretending to prove their innovation by relying on

the Qur’an - the Mutashabih of it - but, this is proof against and not for them. For instance, Christians might claim that [Isa is divine because] the Qur’an states that he is Ruhullah and His Word, which He gave to Mary, all the while ignoring Allah’s statements, 4& C2S&% ji 4He [‘Isa) was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor to him.} [43:59], and, iVerily, the likeness of ‘Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then (He) said to him: "Be!" and he was.} [3:59]. There are other Ayat that clearly assert that Isa is but one of Allah’s creatures and that he is the servant and Messenger of Allah, among other Messengers. Allah’s statement, 4 ifeilj} 4And seeking for its Ta’wil,} to alter them as they desire. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “The Messenger of Allah jg recited, 411 is He Who has sent down to you the Book. In it are verses that are entirely clear, they are the foundations of the Book; and others not entirely clear,}, until, 4Men ofunderstanding} and he said, vWlwn you see those who argue in it (using the Mutashdbihdt) then they are those whom Allah meant. Therefore, beware of f/iem.i” 1 ’ Al-Bukhari recorded a similar Hadith in the Tafstr of this Ahmad 6:48.

Ayah [3:7], as did Muslim in the book of Qadar (the Divine Will) in his Sahih, and Abu Dawud in the Sunnah section of his Sunan, from ‘A’ishah; “The Messenger of Allah recited this Ayah, / f •f, \ , f, » ** -*/ X // / » Jt V ^ dLlc. Jjji ifjil y 4/f is He W/io /ms sen/ down to you the Book, in it are verses that are entirely clear, until, «M’vi yj* vj 4Aw/ none receive admonition except men of understanding He then said, *JLtj L* ^jjJl lili® *When you see those who follow what is not so clear of the Qur’an, then they are those whom Allah described, so beware of f/iem.D” This is the wording recorded by Al-Bukhari. OnlyAllahKnowstheTrue Ta*wU(Interpretation) ofthe Mutashabihat Allah said, 4%% 4at- pu Cj} 4But none knows its Ta’ioil except Allah. Similarly, as preceded in what has been reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “Tafsir is of four types: Tafsir that the Arabs know in their language; Tafsir that no one is excused of being ignorant of; Tafsir that the scholars know; and Tafsir that only Allah knows.”*2 * Scholars of Qur’an recitation have different opinions about pausing at Allah’s Name in this Ayah. This stop was reported from ‘A’ishah, ‘Urwah, Abu Ash- Sha’tha’ and Abu Nahlk. Some pause after reciting, 4 ^ Fath Al-Bari 8 :57 , Muslim 4 :2053 , Abu Dawud 5 :6 (21 At-Tabari 1:75. This report is from a disconnected chain of narrators

115 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3 iAnd those who are firmly grounded in knowledge} saying that the Qur'an does not address the people with what they cannot understand. Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I am among those who are firmly grounded in its Ta'wil interpretation." The Messenger of Allah jfe supplicated for the benefit of Ibn 'Abbas, « ill*-} J iiif «0 Allah! Bestow on him knowledge in the religion and teach him the Ta'ivil (interpretation) Ta'wil has two meanings in the Qur'an, the true reality of things, and what they will turn out to be. For instance, Allah said, ijA 4 iAnd he said : "O my father! This is the Ta'wfl of my dream aforetime!".} [12:100], and, iAivait they just for it's Ta'wil? On the Day (Day of Resurrection) it's Ta'wil is finally fidfilled.}(7:53) refers to the true reality of Resurrection that they were told about. If this is the meaning desired in the Ayah above [3:7], then pausing after reciting Allah's Name is warranted, because only Allah knows the true reality of things. In this case, Allah's statement, iAnd those who are firmly grounded in knowledge is connected to His statement, 4->, &' 4^4 iSay: 'We believe in it"} If the word Ta'wil means the second At-Tabari 6:203. Editor's note; This report is not authentic, and its meaning contradicts the authentic narration from him that he recited the Ayah; "None knows its interpretation except Allah, and the firmly grounded [yaqul] say." This is recorded by At-Tabari 6 :203, and its chain of narrators meets the criteria of Al-Bukhari. Fath Al-Bari 1 :205 [21

116 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, that is, explaining and describing, such as what Allah said, 4(They said): "Inform us of the Ta'wit of this"} meaning its explanation, then pausing after reciting, AAttd those who are firmly grounded in knmoledge is warranted. This is because the scholars have general knowledge in, and understand what they were addressed with, even though they do not have knowledge of the true reality of things. Therefore, Allah's statement, 4- &*' '&} isay: "We believe in it"} describes the conduct of the scholars. Similarly, Allah said, liS Jiy fcj} AAnd your Lord comes, and the angels, in roivs.} [89:22] means, your Lord will come, and the angels will come in rows. Allah's statement that the knowledgeable people proclaim, &'• Sjjju} }We believe in it} means, they believe in the Mutashabih. iall of it is from our Lord} meaning, both the Muhkam and the Mutashabih are true and authentic, and each one of them testifies to the truth of the other. This is because they both are from Allah and nothing that comes from Allah is ever met by contradiction or discrepancy. Allah said, 4 biL'U *j ijijji «il xx. j* f'} "\$•} }Do they not then consider the Qur'an carefully? Had it been from other than Allah, they would surely have found therein many a contradiction .} (4:82). Allah said in his Ayah [3:7], / ***# # J j ij i b>ji

227 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) iAtid none receive admonition except men of understanding .} meaning, those who have good minds and sound comprehension, understand, contemplate and comprehend the meaning in the correct manner. Further, Ibn Al-Mundhir recorded in his Tafslr that Nafi' bin Yazld said, "Those firmly grounded in knowledge are those who are modest for Allah's sake, humbly seek His pleasure, and do not exaggerate

regarding those above them, or belittle those below them."

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 814–860]

Allah said that they supplicate to their Lord, jZ fj 'i £)} iOur Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us.} meaning, "Do not deviate our hearts from the guidance after You

allowed them to acquire it. Do not make us like those who have wickedness in their hearts, those who follow the Mutashabih in the Qur'an. Rather, make us remain firmly on Your straight path and true religion." iAttd grant us from Ladunka} meaning, from You, iMera/} with which You make our hearts firm, and increase in our Faith and certainty, iTruly, You are the Bestower> Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded that Umm Salamah said that the Prophet jfe; used to supplicate, •ILji iji-aJl vl.Ui '0 You Who changes the hearts, make my heart firm on Your religion. » He then recited, .I-'-', ^ » "i +s »* * mS ** »** ***** » 'r-' ^ / *£*\ .A .vUjJl tAlil dl)j] U yjk) JOu Lyi i"0ur Lord! Let not our hearts deviate (from the truth) after You have guided us, and grant us mercy from You. Truly,

118 Tafoir Ibt Kathir J m&m ©up J'-. 1^ > _'t *A\ ^jiAu^4> \s&\Ljj>5S'^4\^j* <L/jj!jOy^j CA^ss-ii Op jL^'o-'V clll.'^^Jtr—>Ljj J& You are the Bestoiver.'V The Ayah continues, yjj cs^i c?^ t4s^ 4»r} Cjj 4M'jlj\4l ' 1)S^-~ ^jyi d& ;g *'^L^V^4^u^Ch\$^uVl ,, v/ *' r ' > * /"r>/ x?>/ » <' • - ^ ^ ,f - -f t^>'".Y\j-p ys->' mI-aJj (*==<J\>Cr^j^i jl 3j^k«jr^yj v 'L\$lk(jjdy)«3 jU- jC Ajjlj <il, JM .- 7 - i"Our Lord! Verily, it is You Who ivill gather mankind together on the Day about which there is no doubt"} meaning, they say in their supplication: O our Lord! You will gather Your creation on the Day of Return, judge between them and decide over what they disputed about. Thereafter, You will reward or punish each according to the deeds they did in this life. jyj (*i »)' cA »-*-<\$ Y> >+!y! ^4-^ J byS* ^1/ ^''' -* ^ >»*» { -?? ** ,?fo '••'. <fl'j (*f:ji , -k ad' j'OO y-4^.* ja JI* wiA£ .. • . < > \jU> ^20. Verily, those who disbelieve, neither their properties nor their offspring will avail than whatsoever against Allah ; and it is they who will be fuel of the Fire.} ill. Like the behavior of the people of Fir'axon and those before them; they belied Our Aydt. So Allah punished them for their sins. And Allah is severe in punishment.} Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :84 , At-Tabari 6 :2 13

On the Day of Resurrection, No Wealth or Offspring Shall Avail Allah states that the disbelievers shall be fuel for the Fire, 4 '* • AiJilll p-rJ-i*4 if Day luhcn their excuses zoill be of tto profit to wrongdoers . Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (i.e. painful torment in Hell-fire.) [40:52]. Further, what they were granted in this life of wealth and offspring shall not avail them with Allah, or save them from His punishment and severe torment. Similarly, Allah said. 4 IJt (4 -44. 'J T Ojjtp ,4-^ ^So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.) [9:55], and, ZWe* 4& tS 4* &% iLet not the free disposal (and affluence) of the disbelievers throughout the land deceive you. A brief enjoyment ; then, their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.) [3:196, 197]. Allah said in this Ayah [3:10], k) iVerily, those who disbelieve) meaning, disbelieved in Allah's Ayat, denied His Messengers, defied His Books and did not benefit from His revelation to His Prophets, iNeither their properties nor their offspring will avail them whatsoever against Allat; and it is they who will be fuel of the Fire.) meaning, they will be the wood with which the Fire is kindled and fed. Similarly, Allah said,

-7 > ' i"- 'Si 1. J* iJJ-U_-*o Uj 4Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel far Hell!} [21:98]. Allah said next, 4oEi Ji iLike the Da'b of the people of Fira'wn .} Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah means, "Like the behavior of the people of Fir'awn." ' This is the same Tafsir of 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, and others. Other scholars said that the Ayah means, "Like the practice, conduct, likeness of the people of Fir'awn."*21

These meanings are all plausible, for the Da'b means practice, behavior, tradition and habit. The Ayah indicates that the disbelievers will not benefit from their wealth or offspring. Rather, they will perish and be punished. This is the same end the people of Fir'aun and the previous nations met, those who rejected the Messengers, the Ayat, and proofs of Allah that they were sent with. And Allah is severe in punishment.} meaning, His punishment is severe and His torment is painful. None can escape Allah's grasp, nor does anything escape His knowledge. Allah does what He wills and prevails over all things, it is He to Whom everything is humbled and there is no deity worthy of worship, nor any Lord except Him. 422. Say to those who disbelieve: "You will be defeated and gathered together to Hell, and worst indeed is that place of rest."} 111 At-Tabari 6:224. ,2) Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :92

121 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) il3. There has already been a sign for you in the two armies that met. One was fighting in the cause of Allah, and as for the other, in disbelief. They saw them with their own eyes twice their number. And Allah supports with His aid whom He wills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand Threatening the Jews With Defeat and Encouraging Them to Learn a Lesson From the Battle of Badr Allah commanded the Prophet Muhammad to proclaim to the disbelievers, 4You will be defeated^ in this life, 4And gathered together^ on the Day of Resurrection, ^& 4to Hell, and worst indeed is that place of rest4 Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar recorded that 'Asim bin "Umar bin Qatadah said that when the Messenger of Allah jg gained victory in the battle of Badr and went back to Al- Madinah, he gathered the Jews in the marketplace of Bani Qaynuqa'. Therefore, Allah said, iThere has already been a sign for you meaning, O Jews, who said what you said! You have an Ayah, meaning proof, that Allah will make His religion prevail, award victory to His Messenger, make His Word apparent and His religion the highest. 4In the two armies^ meaning, two camps, 4that met in combat (in Badr)

iOne was fighting in the Cause of Allah the Muslims, iAnd as for the other, in disbelief} meaning, the idolators of Quraysh at Badr. Allah's statement, iThey saw them with their own eyes twice their number } means, the idolators thought that the Muslims were twice as many as they were, for Allah made this illusion a factor in the victory that Islam had over them. It was said that the meaning of Allah's statement, iThey saw them with their own eyes twice their number} is that the Muslims saw twice as many idolators as they were, yet Allah gave them victory over the disbelievers. 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "When we looked at the disbelievers' forces, we found that they were twice as many as we were. When we looked at them again, we thought they did not have one man more than we had. So Allah's statement. iAnd (remember) when you met, He showed them to you as few in your eyes and He made you appear as few in their eyes.} [8:44]" When the two camps saw each other, the Muslims thought that the idolators were twice as many as they were, so that they would trust in Allah and seek His help. The idolators thought that the believers were twice as many as they were, so that they would feel fear, horror, fright and despair. When the two camps stood in lines and met in battle, Allah made each camp look smaller in the eyes of the other camp, so that they would be encouraged to fight each other, so that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained.} [8:42] m At-Tabari 6 :234

meaning, so that the truth and falsehood are distinguishable, and thus the word of faith prevails over disbelief and deviation, so that the believers prevail and the disbelievers are humiliated. In a similar

statement, Allah said; 4And Allah has already wade you victorious at Badr, when you were a zoeak little force} [3:123], In this Ayah [3:13] Allah said, 4 '&} 4And Allah supports with His victory whom He zvills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand.} meaning, this should be an example for those who have intelligence and sound comprehension. They should contemplate about Allah's wisdom, decisions and decree, that He gives victory to His believing servants in this life and on the Day the witnesses stand up to testify. rU % Qilf }%Zi\ ££% iduft 'Sfy j-Vfi (vfeO'j a? yl~ ^ i . * A3- 414. Beautified for men is the love of things they covet; women, children, Qanatir Al-Muqantarrah of gold and silver, branded beautiful horses (Musawwatnah) , cattle and fertile land. This is the pleasure of the present world's life; but Allah has the excellent return zoith Hint.} 415. Say: "Shall / inform you of things far better than those? For those who have Taqwd there are Cardens (Paradise) with their Lord, underneath which rivers flow. Therein (is their) eternal (home) and Azzvdjun Mutahharatun (purified mates or zvives). And Allah zvill be pleased zoith them. And Allah is All- Seer of the servants."}

124 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The True Value of This Earthly Life Allah mentions the delights that He put in this life for people, such as women and children, and He started with women, because (he test with them is more tempting. For instance, the SahO'i recorded that the Messenger sg said, (Jt>- ^Jlaj y to® «/ did not leave behind me a test more tempting to men than women. n* 1 When one enjoys women for the purpose of having children and preserving his chastity, then he is encouraged to do so. There are many Hadiths that encourage getting married, such as, ;.U> '£ ojj « Verily, the best members of this Ummah are those who have the most wives^2{ He jg also said, UjjJU "This life is a delight, and the best of its delight is a righteous wife {3]

The Prophet jg said in another Hadith, «/ was made to like women and perfume, and the comfort of my eye is the prayer.^41 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "Nothing was more beloved to the Messenger of Allah than women, except horses," and in another narration, "...than horses except women."*51 The desire to have children is sometimes for the purpose of pride and boasting, and as such, is a temptation. When the purpose for having children is to reproduce and increase the |l * FathAl-B&ri9:41. * Fath Al-Bari9:15. That is , a maximum of four at the same time Muslim 2:1090. ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :280 [S] An-Nasal 6:217, 7:61.

325 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3 Ummah of Muhammad sg with those who worship Allah alone without partners, then it is encouraged and praised. A Hadtth states, «Marry the Wadud (kind) and Waliid (fertile) woman, for I ivill compare your numbers to the rest of the nations on the Day of ResurrectionV The desire of wealth sometimes results out of arrogance, and the desire to dominate the weak and control the poor, and this conduct is prohibited. Sometimes, the want for more money is for the purpose of spending it on acts of worship, being kind to the family, the relatives, and spending on various acts of righteousness and obedience; this behavior is praised and encouraged in the religion. Scholars of Tafsir have conflicting opinions about the amount of the Qintar, all of which indicate that the Qintar is a large amount of money, as Ad-Dahhak and other scholars said. Abu Hurayrah said "The Qintar is twelve thousand Uwqiyah, each Uwqiyah is better than what is between the heavens and earth." [This was recorded by Ibn Jarir]. The desire to have horses can be one of three types. Sometimes, owners of horses collect them to be used in the cause of Allah, and when warranted, they use their horses in battle. This type of owner shall be rewarded for this good action. Another type collects horses to boast, and out

of enmity to the people of Islam, and this type earns a burden for his behavior. Another type collects horses to fulfill their needs and to collect their offspring, and they do not forget Allah's right due on their horses. This is why in this case, these horses provide a shield of sufficiency for their owner, as evident by a Hadith that we will mention, Allah willing, when we explain Allah's statement. iAnd make ready against them all you can of power, including steeds of war.} [8:60]. Abu Dawud, An-Nasa'i, and Ibn Hibban 6:134. 121 At-Tabari 6 :250 131 At-Tabari 6:244.

126 Tafsir Ibn Kathir As for the Musawwamah horses, Ibn 'Abbas said that they are the branded, beautiful horses. This is the same explanation of Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Abdullah bin Abza, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and Abu Sinan and others.'2 ' Makhul said the Musawwamah refers to the horse with a white spotted face, and the horse with white feet.'3 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah jf; said, js £* d in ir4"" aJUj jl •" <Jl aJU i— t o-aI3J «Every Arabian horse is allowed to have two supplications every dawn, and the horse supplicates, 'O Allah! You made me subservient to the son of Adam. Therefore, make me among the dearest of his wealth and household to him, or, ...make me the dearest of his household and wealth to him Allah's statement, iCattle} means, camels, cows and sheep. 4&S3fJ> 4And fertile land^ meaning, the land that is used to farm and grow plants. Allah then said, f)SZZ! yg iThis is the pleasure of the present world's life} meaning, these are the delights of this life and its short lived joys, [1 > At-Jabari 6 :2S2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2:123-125. •3| Ibn Abi Hatim 2:127. ' Ahmad 5:170.

127 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) 4But Allah has the excellent return with Him? meaning, the best destination and reward. The Reward of the Those Who Have Taqwa is Better Than All Joys of This World This is why Allah said, 4Say : ",Shall I inform you of things far better than those?" This Ayah means, "Say, O Muhammad, to the people, 'Should I tell you about what is better than the delights and joys of this life that will soon perish?' " Allah informed them of what is better when He said, 4jik'Vl l+ne SyC J-fjJ ix \ 'j&\ itfff} 4For those who have Taqwa there are Gardens (Paradise) with their Lord, underneath which rivers flow^ meaning, rivers run throughout it. These rivers carry various types of drinks: honey, milk, wine and water such that no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, and no heart has ever imagined, 4Therein (is their) eternal (home)} meaning, they shall remain in it forever and ever and will not want to be removed from it. 4 j' 4And Azwdjun Mutahlmraturun (purified mates or wives)} meaning, from filth, dirt, harm, menstruation, post birth bleeding, and other things that affect women in this world. 4And Allah will be pleased with them} meaning, Allah's pleasure will descend on them and He shall never be angry with them after that. This is why Allah said in Surah Bara'ah, o'j-svj} 4But the pleasure of Allah is greater} [9:72], meaning, greater than the eternal delight that He has granted them. Allah then 'ad.

*)'C J\ iAnd Allah is All-Seer of the (His) servants and, He gives each provisions according to what they deserve. kjj LJ ijf jUif i!6. Those who say: "Our Lord! We have indeed believed, so for- give us our sins and save us from the punish- ment of the Fire/y il7. (They are) the patient, the true believ- ers, and obedient ivith sincere devotion in wor- ship to Allah . Those who spend [in good] and those who pray and beg Allah's pardon in the last hours of the nighty The Supplication and Description of Al-Muttaqin Allah describes the Muttaqin, His pious servants, whom He promised tremendous rewards, id& ts; ojji ^jy iThose who say: "Our Lord! We Iwve indeed believed' in You, Your Book and Your

Messenger. 4.S0 forgive us our sins because of our faith in You and in what You legislated for us. Therefore, forgive us our errors and

129Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3) shortcomings, with Your bounty and mercy, fej} iatid save usfrom the punishment of the Fire.} Allah then said, 4Lf&i} 4(They are) those who are patient while performing acts of obedience and abandoning the prohibitions. ithose who are true} concerning their proclamation of faith, by performing the difficult deeds. ianci obedient meaning, they submit and obey Allah, 0wse who spend} from their wealth on all the acts of obedience they were commanded, being kind to kith and kin, helping the needy, and comforting the destitute. &fL3's} iand those who pray and beg Allah's pardon in the last hours of the night} and this testifies to the virtue of seeking Allah's forgiveness in the latter part of the night. It was reported that when Ya'qub said to his children, 41 ivill ask my Lord for forgiveness for you} [12:98] he waited until the latter part of the night to say his supplication. Furthermore, the Two Sahihs, the Musnad and Sunan collections recorded through several Companions that the Messenger of Allah said, 'irrT j. I «*>' ju^La JA ji ?j ji J;U ja ji :JyZ

iRVuqi [e, STS: l unisnw ' ^gg: Z UP8'1V MWd \z\ iet: z pBUiqv set: I qBfeN uqi 'EZl -9 Vjqnx-iv Ui J.BSBN-UV ' IZ>= 6 ?ypom/y -JV jo/qnj, 'if Z pnMBQ nqy ' \Z9 ' - uiqsnw ' ££ [: 1 W8-JV Ml*>d |,] fpsRiu paptmqns aavq /,, : /ivs noR ipioi aindsip Raip ft os 0Z\$ i'Sutuoyaaaj m ifrns st 1/pnv 'R/auns imp 'ifvpy fo jvRy dip ui sanatpqstp jaoaoi/oi puy uiaip o) aiuaa pvq a2pa\i(wu>i uaffv 'Rujvau fo)tto jdaaxa uaffip }ou pip (suvpsuiQ puv saia[]) a.mjduas sip uaat8 auai oi{m asoip 'uippi si ippy ipioi uoi8tpA aip 'R}iu± \$1> i'3S!M-UV 3tU 'RjifinuiV sip 3H piq paddtqsjooi aq oj p(8u aip sin/ auop aapsnf ui uopvaua sip suwfumu (sRooip ap) !(sup o] ssaiprn Jvaq osjv) a8papiou>i 8uta.vi{ asotp puv 'sp8uv aip puv 'ap)tiq paddii{SAO(n aq Of p{8u aip svq auou)Vip ssaipim suvaq t{vpy g/> nfi iTpr i U\ n *f " w £ IT? f \$?, '? W" fi'l !r.5FT 5fp; fl rr r\ \r\$ tri ^ ^r' if jfP j?T ? ifpv »r?^r:f: ^ ^ if ite, » jt-t >p^ (f- && V 15£ & 15 u t sts < fffi iff sb f.%^f ijf^ (e|-uiijBH iqv uqi Aq papaya sb/w ipipop siqx UMBp [pun SSdUaAlSjOJ SJH 9up[33S pUB qB[[V O; 3upB3l[ddnS JJBJS p[nOM JBUia uqi „,sa^ 'ptBS ,IJBm J] PUB (l<il3A ;q3lU 3ip JO JJBd J3JBJ aq; JI SI i.xjBN On ' >{SB p[noM PUB jqSiu oqj 3uunp Asad o; posn jBuifl, uiq qpnnpqv, |e](1 PJBd jobj aqj 3uunp (A[uo) ji uuojjad pjno/w aq '(ajt[siq ui) jajB['uaqx iq3iu aq; jo sued ja;;B[pus aipprai aq; pJBd ;sjij aq; 3uunp JIJM pauuojjad^ qB[[v jo jaSuassaw aqi* 'PP88 qBMs!<Y» l^q; papjooaj sqn/og omx aaiSucfRvui l jvip os 'ssauaaiSwf Ryq Kupaas auoRuv auaij sj iuopvaoai siq oj puodsau Rmu j jvip os 'ay/ ayoaij oj auoRuv ajaip si psanbau siq uiij juvuS Rvui j }vip os 'ay/ ^/sb oj auoRuv auaij s/, 'SuiRvs uacwaif jsarno/ aip oj spuaasap 'jouadns sip 'passajg aip 'pjoq uno 'suwuij p fo puitp)sv{ aip uaiion 'iq8tu Ruaajn 0fluqj utsfvx

to Allah, and (so have) those zohofollow me." And say to those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterate (Arab pagans): "Do you (also) submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn aumy, your duty is only to convey the Message; and Allah sees the servants.} The Testimony ofTawhid Allah bears witness, and verily, Allah is sufficient as a Witness, and He is the Most Truthful and Just Witness there is; His statement is the absolute truth, Vi v g\} ithat La ilaha ilia Huwa} meaning. He Alone is the Lord and God of all creation; everyone and everything are His servants, creation and in need of Him. Allah is the Most Rich, Free from needing anyone or anything. Allah said in another Ayah, «3jji\$ 'C &\$} iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent

dotvn (the Qur'an) unto xjou (O Muhammad jg)} [4: 166J. Allah then mentioned the testimony of His angels and those who have knowledge after he mentioned His own testimony, 'j* vi 'A[v iSt 'if iAlldh bears witness that none has the right to be worshipped but He), and the angels, and those having knowledge (also bear witness to this)}. This Ayah emphasizes the great virtue of those who have knowledge. ^ jilJj\j (iJi^ i(He) maintains His creation in justice in all that He does, Vi % V> iNone has the right to be worshipped but He} thus emphasizing this fact, iX&i^}

ithe Almighty, the All-Wise. fr the Mighty that does not submit to weakness due to His might and greatness, the Wise in all His statements, actions, legislation and decrees. The Religion with Allah is Islam Allah said, ^ k> \$Truly, the religion with Allah is Islm.fr Allah states that there is no religion accepted with Him from any person, except Islam. Islam includes obeying all of the Messengers until Muhammad jg who finalized their commission, thus closing all paths to Allah except through Muhammad jg\$. Therefore, after Allah sent Muhammad s\$, whoever meets Allah following a path other than Muhammad's, it will not be accepted of him. In another Ayah, Allah said, A-~» iyjf frAnd whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhimfr [3:85]. In this Ayah [3:19], Allah said, asserting that the only religion accepted with Him is Islam, frTruly, the religion with Allah is Islm.fr Allah then states that those who were given the Scripture beforehand divided in the religion after Allah sent the Messengers and revealed the Books to them providing them the necessary proofs to not do so. Allah said, tZ >jj\ £ iZ o; iyjl frThose who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) did not differ except out of rivalry, after knowledge had come to them.fr meaning, some of them wronged others. Therefore, they differed over the truth, out of envy, hatred and enmity for each other. This hatred made some of them defy those whom they hated even if they were correct. Allah then said,

4And whoever disbelieves in the Ayat ofAllah} meaning, whoever rejects what Allah sent down in His Book, 4then surely, Allah is Swift in reckoning.} Allah will punish him for his rejection, reckon him for his denial, and torment him for defying His Book. Thereafter, Allah said. 4So if they dispute with you (Muhammad so if they argue with you about Tawhid, & iSv-j Cm Jiiy 4Say: "I have submitted myself to Allah (in Islam), and (so have) those whofollow me"} meaning, Say, 1 have made my worship sincere for Allah Alone without partners, rivals, offspring or companion, iand those who follmo me} who followed my religion and embraced my creed.' In another Ayah, Allah said, Cr*J ilk <J'» 4Say (O Muhammad sg): "This is my way; I invite unto Allah with sure knowledge, I and whosoever follows me..."} [12:108]. Islam is the Religion ofMankindand the Prophet^Was Sent to all Mankind Allah commanded His servant and Messenger, Muhammad Si» to ca21 the People of the Two Scriptures and the unlettered idolaters to his religion, way, Law and all that Allah sent him with. Allah said. J& IjiSif [yl-J jji iyjl Jij} 4And say to those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) and to those who are illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do

you (also) submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message. ^ meaning, their reckoning is with Allah and their return and final destination is to Him. It is He Who guides whom He wills and allows whom He wills to stray, and He has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof for all of this. This is why Allah said, 4^ 'dj) iAnd Allah sees the servants.) for He has perfect knowledge ofwho deserves to be guided and who does not deserve to be guided. Verily, i-i J Vf 4He cannot be questioned for what He does, while they will be

questioned.) [21:23] because of His perfect wisdom and mercy. This and similar Ayat are clear proofs that the Message of Muhammad jg is universal to all creation, as it is well established in the religion, according to the various texts of the Book and Sunnah. For instance, Allah said, iSay (O Muhammad : “O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah.”) [7:158], and, iBlessed be He Wlw sent down the criterion to His servant that he may be a warner to the 'Alamtn (mankind and Jinn).) [25:1]. The Two Sahihs and other collections of Hadith recorded that the Prophet jg sent letters to the kings of the earth during his time and to different peoples, Arabs and non-Arabs, People of the Book and the unlettered, just as Allah had commanded him. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ma‘mar said, that 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :42 , Muslim 4 :1993

Hamman said that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, y *1 fjA jS- 1 V l 0jJj (jjjjl «J0) ji?^ 015 ^1 tJ, ±Lj\ jjj By He in Whose Hand is my soul! No member of this Ummah, no Jew or Christian, hears of me but dies without believing in what I was sent with, but will be among the people of the Fire . » Muslim recorded this Hadlth. • The Prophet sg said, i Ji "l was sent to the red and black. and, “ilt ^-01 Jj j lijsbi- Ajy J^ll fclJ0 jIS «A Prophet used to be sent to his people, but l was sent to all mankind. »|31 'b-k <«' si' 5^ JLiX Si' >A>?5 vjjQ' > -j»; ^^£ jU-vsf;^ 421 . Verily, those who disbelieve in the Aydt of Allah and kill the Prophets without right, and kill those men who order just dealings, then announce to them a painful torment. i22 . They are those whose works will be lost in this world and in the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers Chastising the Jews for Their Disbelief and for Killing the Prophets and Righteous People This Ayah chastises the People of the Book for the transgression and prohibitions they committed by their denials in the past and more recent times, of Allah’s Aydt and the Messengers. They did this due to their defiance and rejection of the Messengers, denial of the truth and refusal to follow it. ^ Muslim 1 :134. ^ Muslim no. 371 Al-Bukhari no. 335.

They also killed many Prophets when they conveyed to them

what Allah legislated for them, without cause or criminal behavior committed by these Prophets, for they only called them to the truth, iAini kill those men who order just dealings thus, demonstrating the worst type of arrogance. Indeed,

the Prophet said, L o P) *,L ; tKibr (arrogance) is refusing the truth and degrading people»(11 This is why when they rejected the truth and acted arrogantly towards the creation, Allah punished them with humiliation and disgrace in this life, and humiliating torment in the Hereafter. Allah said, # amm er m® ^ ijis. y. /y */ (»> y^^- y -i > I ^ > ifj 'ojiaOi 0 f6 >4~; J-^9 £ a j3^ JLwillUil iJJB <. < TA </ *. *1,7 . .ss n announce to them a painful torment} meaning, painful and humiliating, y’Slfj s j yJ*tiLcS - jjLi- iThey are those whose works will be lost in this world and in the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers.}. m Muslim 1 :93

i* Is ZZ'fXi fS & V& ^S\ £ 4i &1^ J> 3 j j\$J> O'jjjJU 6\$ jl5)> tills j 'jtt t&i'i Tr,SA^i (**» <i> u^ jAa *~> vsj *H *^3 K^i^i i>V£=. i; 4.,;^^ V ,US 423 . Have you not seen those who have been given a portion of the Scripture? They are being invited to the Book of Allah to settle their dispute, then a party of them turned away, and they are averse.> 424. This is because they say: "The Fire shall not touch us but for a number of days." And that which they used to invent in their religion has deceived them.} 425. How (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt (i.e. the Day

of Resurrection). And each person will be paid in full what he has earned? And they will not be dealt with unjustly.} Chastising the People of the Book for Not Referring to the Book of Allah for Judgment Allah criticizes the Jews and Christians who claim to follow their Books, the Tawrah and the Injil, because when they are called to refer to these Books where Allah commanded them to follow Muhammad jg, they turn away with aversion. This censure and criticism from Allah was all because of their defiance and rejection. Allah said next, 4# <4 ' -ii idsi j iju iTItis is because they say : "The Fire shall not touch us but for a number of days."} meaning, what made them dare to challenge and defy the truth is their false claim that Allah will only punish them for seven days in the Fire, a day for every one thousand years in this life. We mentioned this subject in the Tafsir of Surat Al- Baqarah. Allah then said,

\$And that which they used to invent regarding their religion has deceived them.} meaning, what caused them to remain on their false creed is that they deceived themselves, believing that the Fire will only touch them for a few days for their errors. However, it is they who have invented this notion, and Allah did not grant them authority to support this claim. Allah said, while threatening and warning them, iHow (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt (i.e. the Day of Resurrection).} meaning, what will their condition be like after they have uttered this lie about Allah, rejected His Messengers and killed His Prophets and their scholars who enjoined righteousness and forbade evil? Allah will ask them about all this and punish them for what they have done. This is why Allah said, ViJ V \ j2S3} iHow (will it be) when We gather them together on the Day about which there is no doubt.} meaning, there is no doubt that this Day will come, i<£>fUij V li j£=» Slijj} iAnd each person will be paid in full what he has earned? And they will not be dealt with unjustly.}. <j" j-w gjoj -iGif £ d&is jji \ (in J,) >i £&* <1& ^ur\$& VCii ^ jj45 i jf* iLiS £ OiPj Ifii cGI' gfjj ll j}\$\ fcpiuj 126. Say: "O Allah! Possessor of the power, You give power to whom You will, and You take power from whom You will, and You endue with honor whom You will, and You humiliate whom You will. In Your Hand is the good. Verily, You are able to do all things.} 127. You make the night to enter into the day, and You make the day to enter into the night, You bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living. And You give

239Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) — wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit .} Encouraging Gratitude Allah said, iSay} O Muhammad sH, while praising your Lord, thanking Him, relying in all matters upon Him and trusting in Him. SiJ£ .Lility 40 Allah! Possessor of the power} meaning, all sovereignty is Yours, 4You give power to whom You will, and You take power from whom You will, and You endue with honor whom You will, and You humiliate whom You will.} meaning, You are the Giver, You are the Taker, it is Your will that occurs and whatever You do not will, does not occur. This Ayah encourages thanking Allah for the favors He granted His Messenger jg and his Ummah. Allah transferred the prophethood from the Children of Israel to the Arab, Qurashi, Makkan, unlettered Prophet, the Final and Last of all Prophets and the Messenger of Allah jg to all mankind and Jinn. Allah endowed the Prophet jg with the best of qualities from the prophets before him. Allah also granted him extra qualities that no other Prophet or Messenger before him was endowed with, such as granting him (more) knowledge of Allah and His Law, knowledge of more of the matters of the past and the future, such as what will occur in the Hereafter. Allah allowed Muhammad's Ummah to reach the eastern and western parts of the world and gave dominance to his religion and Law over all other religions and laws. May Allah's peace and blessings be on the Prophet jg until the Day of Judgment,

and as long as the day and night succeed each other. This is why Allah said, 4<iiiK isf J+bi £} iSay: "O Allah! Possessor of the power,"} meaning, You decide what You will concerning Your creation and You do what you will. Allah refutes those who thought that they could decide for Allah,

o? J~J& <}*/\$ 'i* Jj 'ijj i\$lij} iAnd they say: Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the two towns (Makkah and Ta'if)?"} [43:3 lj. Allah refuted them by saying, i&> cSC Jji-i' \$} ils it they who would portion out the Mercy of your Lord?} [43:32], meaning, "We decide for Our creation what We will, without resistance or hindrance by anyone. We have the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proof in all of this, and We give the prophethood to whom We will." Similarly, Allah said, viX iAlldh knows best with whom to place His Message> and, (i! 4See hozo We prefer one above another (in this world)) [17:21] Allah said, 4 glpj jiQil 4 4You make the night enter into the day, and You make the day enter into the night} meaning, You take from the length of one of them and add it to the shortness of the other, so that they become equal, and take from the length of one of them and add it to the other so that they are not equal. This occurs throughout the seasons of the year: spring, summer, fall and winter. Allah's statement, iYou bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living.} means, You bring out the seed from the plant: and the plant from the seed; the date from its seed and the date's seed from the date; the faithful from the disbeliever and the disbeliever from the faithful; the chicken from the egg and the egg from the chicken, etc.

141Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) 4y^i- JpJ '*& 0* <J&j¥ iAtid You give wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit. meaning, You give whomever You will innumerable amounts of wealth while depriving others from it, out of wisdom, and justice. j *3' IjA j'J i>i» Cri \$-4^ Z-V. > /-if * <•' •>' ; -4 428. Lef not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, unless you indeed fear a danger from them And Allah loams you against Himself, and to Allah is the final return .} The Prohibition ofSupporting the Disbelievers Allah prohibited His believing servants from becoming supporters of the disbelievers, or to take them as comrades with whom they develop friendships, rather than the believers. Allah warned against such behavior when He said, 4\$ iAnd whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way meaning, whoever commits this act that Allah has prohibited, then Allah will discard him. Similarly, Allah said, jElj' Y ni' 40 you who believe! Take not My enemies and your enemies as friends, shozving affection toioards them}, until, ;P jS ji i£b 4Atid whosoever of you does that, then indeed he has gone astrayfrom the straight path.} [60:1]. Allah said. ijjiJi Y '>*• cyM ^

- — Tafsir Ibn Kathir iO you who believe! Take not forfriends disbelievers instead of believers. Do you wish to offer Allah a manifest proof against yourselves?) [4:144], and. 'Q? ;yj' jj£jl ijijrii V [ySll S.ji' <0 you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as friends, they are but friends of each other. And ivhoever befriends than, then surely, he is one ofthem.) [5:51], Allah said, after mentioning the fact that the faithful believers gave their support to the faithful believers among the Muhajirfn, Ansar and Bedouins, 3'—O cJfJVI ^4 .jUC VI i3)\ iAnd those who disbelieve are allies ofone another, (and) ifyou do not behave the same, there will be Fitnah and oppression on the earth, and a great mischiefand corruption.) [8:73]. Allah said next, ioi oi VJ^ iunless you indeedfear a dangerfrom than) meaning, except those believers who in some areas or times fear for their safety from the disbelievers. In this case, such believers are allowed to show friendship to the disbelievers outwardly, but never inwardly.

For instance, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Ad-Darda' said, "We smile in the face of some people although our hearts curse them."¹¹¹ Al-Bukhari said that Al-Hasan said, "The Tuqyah¹² is allowed until the Day of Resurrection." Allah said, & ' < & & {,) i And Allah warns you against Himself.) meaning, He warns you against His anger and the severe torment He prepared for those who give their support to His enemies, and those who have enmity with His friends, m Fath Al-Bari 10:544. 12)1 To shield what is in one's heart

. » /V" / •ll- Ljl.mVjfOtf 4^f ^&» ^Anrf to AZ/a/j is the final return^ meaning, the return is to Him and He will reward or punish each person according to their deeds. jt 4 t» b*^" o[ji]> & iiC 614 £ £{; 4 « *sziT •*?" fJ* ;Jr ip3 ^ /> »y 4 > yy- 0; u 19* J^=> yy-* u* '1 wj J/ x y-' *2 .< 1JU^> iJU! *-4"£ tJ' 3 « >- .<<(•.- ^:r >r)!<a U>J*J *1!>J ;<—*» «0l |»£=>jJ~i) 4® 429. Say: "Whether you hide what is in your breasts or reveal it, Allah knows it, and He knows what is in the heavens and what is in the earth. And Allah is able to do all things") 430. On the Day when every person will be confronted with the good he has done, and all the evil he has done, he will wish that there were a great distance between him and his evil. And Allah warns you against Himself and Allah is full of kindness with the servants .) Allah Knows What the Hearts Conceal Allah tells His servants that He knows the secrets and apparent matters and that nothing concerning them escapes His observation. Rather, His knowledge encompasses them in all conditions, time frames, days and instances. His knowledge encompasses all that is in heaven and earth, and nothing not

even the weight of an atom, or what is smaller than that in the earth, seas and mountains, escapes His observation. Indeed, 4And Allah is able to do all things.} and His ability encompasses everything. This Ayah alerts Allah's servants that they should fear Him enough to not commit what He prohibits and dislikes, for He has perfect knowledge in all they do and is able to punish them promptly. And He gives respite to some of them, then He punishes them, and He is Swift and Mighty in taking account. This is why Allah said afterwards. Jr Uj ' ^S* 'd jJb -L5 fy} iOn the Day when every person will be confronted with all the good he has done,} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, Allah brings the good and evil deeds before the servant, just as He said, fj j ^ 40n that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind.} [75:13). When the servant sees his good deeds, he becomes happy and delighted. When he sees the evil deeds he committed, he becomes sad and angry. Then he will wish that he could disown his evil work and that a long distance separated it from him. He will also say to the devil who used to accompany him in this life, and who used to encourage him to do evil; 4"Would that between me and you were the distance of the two easts" - a horrible companion (indeed)!} [43:38], Allah then said, while threatening and warning, 4And Allah warns you against Himself} meaning, He warns you against His punishment. Allah then said, while bringing hope to His servants, so that they do not despair from His mercy or feel hopeless of His kindness.

4And Allah is full of kindness with the servants> Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "Allah is so kind with them that He warns them against Himself." Others commented,^ "He is merciful with His creation and likes for them to remain on His straight path and chosen religion, and to follow His honorable Messenger." *> J*X Jtjfy iif oj ii. -5 4(U ou L4455 -il idj.1 431 . Say (O Muhammad sg to mankind): "If you (really) love Allah, then follow me (i.e. Muhammad), Allah will love you and forgive you your sins. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.y 432. Say : "Obey Allah and the Messenger." But if they turn away,

then Allah does not like the disbelievers> Allah's Love is Attained by Following the Messenger^ This honorable Ayah judges against those who claim to love Allah, yet do not follow the way of Muhammad sg. Such people are not true in their claim until they follow the Shari'ah (Law) of Muhammad jg and his religion in all his statements, actions and conditions. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah 2g said, <i>j UjA oWhoever commits an act that does not conform with our matter (religion), then it will be rejected o//»m.» This is why Allah said here, 4Say (O Muhammad jg to mankind) : "If you (really) love Allah, then follow me, Allah will love you..." meaning, what you will earn is much more than what you At-Tabari 6 :202 Fath Al-Bari 5 :355

Si 'r****? %i3 rT.Cfl^J' J* o>-£- J'o Vyj f»U 1 ,*ru f . * f ' .?-/ 4 ./ ^ ..n ,>JU- 433. Allah chose Adam, Nuh (Noah), the family of Ibrahim and the family of 'Imran above the nations 434. Offspring, one of the other, and Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower> The Chosen Ones Among the People of the Earth Allah states that He has chosen these households over the people of the earth. For instance, Allah chose Adam, created him with His Hand and blew life into him. Allah commanded the angels to prostrate before Adam, taught him the names of everything and allowed him to dwell in Paradise, but then sent him down from it out of His wisdom. Allah chose Nuh and made him the first Messenger to the people of the earth, when the people worshipped idols and associated others with Allah in worship. Allah avenged the way Nuh was treated, for he kept calling his people day and night, in public and in secret, for a very long time. However, his calling them only made them shun him more, and this is when Nuh supplicated against them. So Allah caused them to drown, and none among them was saved, except those who followed the religion that Allah sent to Nuh. Allah also chose the household of Ibrahim, including the master of all mankind, and the Final Prophet, Muhammad, peace be upon him. Allah also chose the household of Imran, the father of Maryam bint Imran, the mother of 'Isa, peace be upon them. So Isa is from the offspring of Ibrahim, as we will mention in the Tafsir of Surat Al-An'am, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. ^ U OjX ^ Cjj o>Sr cJli V& U*&%\$ Xfri # eft a Ss ifri}}') iff) 'As ff (Remember) when the wife of 'Imran said : "O my Lord! I have vowed to You what is in my womb to be dedicated for Your services, so accept this from me. Verily, You are the All-Hearer, the All-Knowing."4

149 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) the newly born the day it is born, as is apparent from the Ayah, which is also a part of the law of those who were before us. Further, the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah jg mentioned that the Prophet jg said, (*r?'3?|J r^; ' J jjj "This night, a son was born for me and I called him by my father's name, Ibrahim .» Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this Hadith. They also recorded that Anas bin Malik brought his newborn brother to the Messenger of Allah sg who chewed a piece of date and put it in the child's mouth and called him 'Abdullah.*2 Other new born infants were also given names on the day they were born. Qatadah narrated that Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, that Samurah bin Jundub said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, fJi "Every newborn boy held in security by his 'Aqiqah, until his seventh day, a sacrifice is offered on his behalf, he is given a name, and the hair on his head is shaved.» This Hadith was collected by Ahmad and the collectors of the Sunan,*3 * and was graded Sahih by At-Tirmidhi. We should mention that another narration for this Hadith contained the wording, "and blood is offered on his behalf," which is more famous and established than the former narration, and Allah knows best. Allah's statement that Maryam's mother said, 4"...And I seek refuge with You for her and for her offspring from Shaytan, the outcast means, that she sought refuge with

Allah from the evil of Shaytan, for her and her offspring, i.e., Isa, peace be upon him. Allah accepted her supplication, for ‘Abdur-Razzaq u * Fath Al-Bari 3 :306 , Muslim 4 :1807 * Fath Al-Bdri 9:501. Ahmad 5:7, Abu Dawud 3:259, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:115, An- Nasal 7 : 166 , Ibn Mfijah 2 : 1057

4And put her under the care of Zakariyya} meaning, Allah made Zakariyya her sponsor. Allah made Zakariyya Maryam’s guardian for her benefit, so that she would learn from his tremendous knowledge and righteous conduct. He was the husband of her maternal aunt, as Ibn Ishaq and Ibn Jarir stated, or her brother-in-law, as mentioned in the Sahih, </ saw John and 'isa, who are maternal cousins .s'11 We should state that ,in general terms, what Ibn Ishaq said is plausible, and in this case, Maryam was under the care of her maternal aunt. The Two Sahlhs recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg decided that ‘Amarah, the daughter of Hamzah, be raised by her maternal aunt, the wife of JaYar bin Abi Talib, saying, “77ie maternal aunt is just like the mother.»121 Allah then emphasizes Maryam’s honor and virtue at the place of worship she attended, iEvery time he entered the Mihrdb to (visit) her, he found her supplied with sustenance.} Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Ash-Sha‘tha, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ar-Rabf bin Anas, ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi and As-Suddi said, “He would find with her the fruits of the summer during winter, and the fruits of the winter during summer.”131 When Zakariyya would see this; ifo fZi tit 4He said: "O Maryam! From where have you gotten this?"} 111 FathAl-Bari 6:539. 121 Fath Al-Bari7:571. 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :227-229.

umij&s ii.> > , C. AJ > JJ Js_*Ai_>JJtt iAj) UA A. pj_aijAjaSCjIJ' AtJl!l —i-b^A..'.U > -#./ .» •{*>' . *'<' -V <> , >^ t \$iisc <Uil jj 4fl 5“ *^S <y *Aii 4S//e said, “This is from Allah." Verily, Allah provides sustenance to whom He wills, without limit.} JU AJJ ^jA-a»} li-i . ‘AU’ A^ <:-? 'fiA , •" "oj> - y*jJ J; 4 >-> yj •TA^JwJl Y&\ ili ^ £ £iijt && jj^i; 'i> it wi^jf j <i' jj Sp ,T' . 'j,,^1>J d_ oy*£ C\$1 y; vH- u ^ 3l> JV^=J !• ’ iuj U 4»f AtjfjS l/££zS» viijj Vi AiiU Vi *i^i> jli i_»i* v)-^* Jii 4£&jij ^ii gzs <,< • ,a<s>» <• > ':' * - ""\ c .i- \"" p^J/ -" +C>i' ' m' \$Z'SS*i • \S ""S> »t ^ cry>& 'o?3?JAI 'jW-J pyo: meaning, where did you get these fruits from? £ <+ JC£ ji lilli^ 43S. Af that time Zakariyyd invoked his Lord, saying: "O my Lord! Grant me from You, a good offspring. You are indeed the All-Hearer of invocation.”} 439. Then the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the Mihrdb, (saying): "Allah gives you glad tidings of Yahya, believing in the Word from Allah, and Sayyidan, and Hasuran, a Prophet, from among the righteous.”} 440. He said: “O my Lord! Hoio can I have a son when I am very old, and my wife is barren?" (Allah) said: "Thus Allah does what He wills.”}

442. He said: "O my Lord! Make a sign for me.” (Allah) said: “Your sign is that you shall not speak to the people for three days except by signals. And remember your Lord much, and glorify (Him) in the afternoon and in the morning. The Supplication of Zakariyya, and the Good News of Yahya’s Birth When Zakariyya saw that Allah provided sustenance for Maryam by giving her the fruits of winter in summer and the fruits of summer in winter, he was eager to have a child of his own. By then, Zakariyya had become an old man, his bones feeble and his head full of gray hair. His wife was an old woman who was barren. Yet, he still supplicated to Allah and called Him in secret, 40 my Lord! Grant me from Ladunka,} from You, iU 4A good offspring^ meaning, a righteous offspring, iYou are indeed the All-Hearer of invocation Allah said, iThen the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the Mihrdb,} meaning, the angels spoke to him directly while he was secluded, standing in prayer at his place of worship. Allah told us about the good news that the angels delivered to Zakariyya, 4^ iAllah

gives you glad tidings of Yaliya of a child from your offspring, his name is Yahya. Qatadah and other scholars said that he was called Yahya (literally, lie lives') because Allah filled his life with faith. m Ibn Abi Hatim 2:235.

254 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah said next, 4U * &*£} ibelievittg in the Word from Allah} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, and also Al-Hasan, Qatadah, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Abu Ash-Shatha, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak, and several others said that the Ayah, 4i^ Si blEt} ^believing in the Word from Allah means, "Believing in Isa, son of Maryam. Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, Qatadah and Said bin Jubayr said that Allah's statement, 4f±Z',} iAnd Sayyidan means, a wise man. 121 Ibn 'Abbas, Ath-Thawri and Ad-Dahhak said that Sayyidan means, "The noble, wise and pious man."131 Said bin Al-Musayyib said that Sayyid is the scholar and Faqth, 'Atiyah said that Sayyid is the man noble in behavior and piety. 'Ikrimah said that it refers to a person who is not overcome by anger, while Ibn Zayd said that it refers to the noble man. Mujahid said that Sayyidan means, honored by Allah. Allah's statement, 4And Hasuran does not mean he refrains from sexual relations with women, but that he is immune from illegal sexual relations. This does not mean that he does not marry women and have legal sexual relations with them, for Zakariyya said in his supplication for the benefit of Yahya, 4 Ji 4 iGrant me from You, a good offspring}, meaning, grant me a son who will have offspring, and Allah knows best. Allah's statement, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :235-237. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :238 At-Tabari 6:375.376.

4A Prophet, from among the righteous} delivers more good news of sending Yahya as Prophet after the good news that he will be born. This good news was even better than the news of Yahya's birth. In a similar statement, Allah said to the mother of Musa, 4'^-dftfr •A-4-J VJ1> 4Verily, We shall bring him back to you, and shall make him one of the Messengers.} [28:7] When Zakariyya heard the good news, he started contemplating about having children at his age. He said, 436 4^=3' •>*>» (Ai* 4 j* <5^* 3'-*^' 4"0 my Lord! How can I have a son when I am very old, and my wife is barren?" (He) said...} meaning the angel said, 4 u <*& } 4"Thus Allah does what He wills."} meaning, this is Allah's matter, He is so Mighty that nothing escapes His power, nor is anything beyond His ability. 4*j* 4 3""^' V-* 36^ 4He said : "0 my Lord! Make a sign for me"} meaning make a sign that alerts me that the child will come, 4">*j Y) .Ay ilib 4>UJ' 36^ 4(Alldh) said: "Your sign is that you shall not speak to the people for three days except by signals."} meaning, you will not be able to speak except with signals, although you are not mute. In another Ayah, Allah said, 4£frju UH} 4For three nights, though having no bodily defect.} [19:10] Allah then commanded Zakariyya to supplicate, thank and praise Him often in that condition, iMt> 0^3 te- £3M} 4And remember your Lord much and glorify (Him) in the

156 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir afternoon and in the morning We will elaborate more on this subject in the beginning of Surah Maryam (chapter 19), Allah willing. tjLUlw* •»' yJS t*J ^4) ce , ir C^AJ0" £* tjf'j's Iioiwl'j Xir-i 4 . al rti-J ^~=>» j^V JjSo jj ^42. And (remember) when the angels said: "O Maryam! Verily, Allah has chosen you, purified you, and chosen you above the women of the nations." 443. "O Maryam! Submit yourself with obedience (Aqnuti) to your Lord and prostrate yourself, and bow down along with Ar-Radki'in 444 . This is a part of the tidings of the Ghayb (Unseen) which We reveal to you. You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens as to which of them should be charged with the care of Maryam; nor were you with them when they disputed The Virtue of Maryam Over the Women of Her Time Allah states that the angels spoke to Maryam by His command and told her that He chose

her because of her service to Him, because of her modesty, honor, innocence, and conviction. Allah also chose her because of her virtue over the women of the world. At-Tirmidhi recorded that ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, v-**! i 1 ’ ‘The best woman (in her time) was Maryam, daughter of ‘Imran, and the best woman (of the Prophet’s time) is Khadijah (his wife), daughter of Khuwaylid^W The Two Sahihs recorded this Hadith)^{2^} Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Musa Al-Ash‘ari said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, J oi; MJ *UJl j* (Jj SjeS * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10 : 388 FcUh Al-B&ri 6:542, Muslim 4 :1886

men achieved perfection, but among women, only Maryam the daughter of ‘Imran and Asfah, the wife of Fir‘aivn, achieved perfection . »* 1 The Six - with the exception of Abu Dawud - recorded it. Al-Bukhari’s wording for it reads, ft]*) ‘ 0 \y\ (Jj ‘j~\$ J>\ J iMany men reached the level of perfection, but no woman reached such a level except Asiah, the wife of Fir‘aivn, and Maryam, the daughter of ‘Imran. The superiority of ‘A’ishah (his wife) to other women, is like the superiority of Tharid (meat and bread dish) to other meals . |3) We mentioned the various chains of narration and wordings for this Hadith in the story of Isa, son of Maryam, in our book, Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah, all the thanks are due to Allah. Allah states that the angels commanded Maryam to increase acts of worship, humbleness, submission, prostration, bowing, and so forth, so that she would acquire what Allah had decreed for her, as a test for her. Yet, this test also earned her a higher grade in this life and the Hereafter, for Allah demonstrated His might by creating a son inside her without male intervention. Allah said, 4"0 Maryam! Submit yourself with obedience (Aqnuti) and prostrate yourself, and bow down along with Ar-Raki‘in.”} As for Qunut (Aqnuti in the Ayah), it means to submit with humbleness. In another Ayah, Allah said, 111 At-Jabari 6:397. 121 Fath Al-Bari 6 :543 , Muslim 4 :1886 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :563 , An- Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :93 , Ibn Majah 2 :1091 131 Fath Al-Bari⁷ A33.

4Nay, to Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth, and all surrender with obedience (Qdnitiin) to Him .> [2:116] Allah next said to His Messenger jg after He mentioned Maryam’s story, iThis is a part of the news of the Ghayb which We reveal “and narrate to you (O Muhammad jfe),” 4You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens as to which of them should be charged with the care of Maryam; nor were you with them when they disputed . meaning, “You were not present, O Muhammad, when this occurred, so you cannot narrate what happened to the people as an eye witness. Rather, Allah disclosed these facts to you as if you were a witness, when they conducted a lottery to choose the custodian of Maryam, seeking the reward of this good deed.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Ikrimah said, “Maryam’s mother left with Maryam, carrying her in her infant cloth, and took her to the rabbis from the offspring of Aaron, the brother of Musa. They were responsible for taking care of Bayt Al-Maqdis (the Masjidj at that time, just as there were those who took care of the Ka’bah. Maryam’s mother said to them, Take this child whom I vowed [to serve the Masjid\, I have set her free, since she is my daughter, for no menstruating woman should enter the Masjid, and I shall not take her back home.’ They said, ‘She is the daughter of our Imam,’ as Imran used to lead them in prayer, ‘who took care of our sacrificial rituals.’ Zakanyya said, ‘Give her to me, for her maternal aunt is my wife.’ They said, ‘Our hearts cannot bear that you take her, for she is the daughter of our Imam.’ So they conducted a lottery with the pens with which they wrote the Tawrah, and Zakariyya won the lottery and took Maryam into his care.’” . ‘Ikrunah,*2 As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas, and several m At-Jabari 6:351. [a] Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :266

Jr fZ*>\ S, >' >S>' >. >' ci'sVxU &4 ^ ^~*y' <i^~j4o|p Cf<5 Oj*-k\j«&'ij£j(s ©^ &i: jj. others' 11 said that the rabbis went into the Jordan river and conducted a lottery there, deciding to throw their pens into the river. The pen that remained afloat and idle would indicate that its owner would take care of Maryam. When they threw their pens into the river, the water took all the pens under, except Zakariyya's pen, which remained afloat in its place. Zakariyya was also their master, chief, scholar, Imam and Prophet, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him and the rest of the Prophets. 4 l+j-j j) J-uz £_!!' i*— ' r!/rW «i' ^>» ('rtr*-i oJS . j-fj' 4 <^1 * (4^=4j tijili t2|> 0^ lit lt*4 C it #£=, 3s 5i? £ %' 4 £& 41£ J: ;i& 445. (Remember) when the angels said: "O Maryam! Verily, Allah gives you the glad tidings of a Word from Him, his name will be Al-Masili, 'Isa, the son of Maryam, held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and he will be one of those ivho are near to Allah "> 111 Ibn Abi HAtim 2 : 267,268.

446. "He will speak to the people, in the cradle and in manhood, and he will be one of the righteous .
447. She said: "O my Lord! How shall I have a son when no man has touched me." He said: "So (it will be) for Allah creates what He wills. When He has decreed something, He says to it only: 'Be!' - and it is.") Delivering the Good News to Maryam of 'Isa's Birth This Ayah contains the glad tidings the angels brought to Maryam that she would give birth to a mighty son who will have a great future. Allah said, 4*A ArrH ul cJL» 4(Remember) ivheti the angels said: "O Maryam! Verily, Alldlt gives you the glad tidings of a Word from Him, a son who will come into existence with a word from Allah, •Be', and he was. This is the meaning of Allah's statement (about Yahya) 4Believing in the Word from Allah. [3:39], according to the majority of the scholars. 4His name will be Al-Masih, 'Isa, the son of Maryam) and he will be known by this name in this life, especially by the believers. 'Isa was called "Al-Masih" (the Messiah) because when he touched (Mash) those afflicted with an illness, they would be healed by Allah's leave. Allah's statement, 4'Isd, the son of Maryam relates 'Isa to his mother, because he did not have a father. ojj JjjSb W-J' 4 4Held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and will be one of those who are near to Allah.) meaning, he will be a leader and honored by Allah in this life,

162 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3 because of the Law that Allah will reveal to him, sending down the Scripture to him, along with the other bounties that Allah will grant him with. 'Isa will be honored in the Hereafter and will intercede with Allah, by His leave, on behalf of some people, just as is the case with his brethren the mighty Messengers of Allah, peace be upon them all. 'Isa Spoke When He was Still in the Cradle Allah said, 4•*+£=> j J-Li' 4He will speak to the people, in the cradle and in manhood,} calling to the worship of Allah Alone without partners, while still in the cradle, as a miracle from Allah, and when he is a man, by Allah's revelation to him. Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, "No infant spoke in tire cradle except 'isd and the companion of /wray/." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet s£r said, If? *) 'g.Jr J -^ trr°s 'ir-F: ji pJ «No infant spoke in the cradle except three, 'Isd, the boy during the time of Jurayj, and another toy.»|2 ' 4And he will be one of the righteous .} in his statements and actions, for he will possess, pure knowledge and righteous works. 'Isa was Created Without a Father When Maryam heard the good news that the angels conveyed from Allah, she said; 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :272,273. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2:272, Fath Al-Bdri no . 3436, Muslim 2550.

4TM“*^ jJj 4 jf ^j¥ 4"0 my Lord! How shall I have a son when no man has touched me.”} Mary said, “How can I have a son while I did not marry, nor intend to marry, nor am I an indecent woman, may Allah forbid?” The angel conveyed to Maryam, Allah’s answer, 4 'if iSo (it will be) for Allah creates what He wills. He is Mighty in power and nothing escapes His ability. Allah used the word ‘create’ here instead of the word ‘does’ as in the tale about Zakariyya [3:40], to eradicate any evil thought concerning Isa. Allah next emphasized this fact when He said, Jr ii iWheti He has decreed something, He says to it only: "Be!" - and it is.} meaning, what Allah wills, comes into existence instantly and without delay. In another Ayah, Allah said, ” t iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.} [54:50], meaning, “We only issue the command once, and it comes into existence instantly, as fast as, and faster than, a blink of the eye.” -** 4' zip 41 w LxZj} 'jfi jjllj JS£\ *• ojijlf ji fCjii j Oj£\5 Uj pSliJj <j]f OiU jjjf ^jv5 4jjaVl‘ J;v «I)f 4) liiifj .w o'^ ijS *iU'i 4 'jUS oj /?#! tfjf ,>* |^=»3 tfc* ».4££ 1^=4j5 6[448. And He will teach him the Book and Al-Hikmah, and the Tawrah and the Ittijl.} 449. And will make him a Messenger to the Children of Israel

163Sitrah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) (saying) : "I have come to you with a sign from your Lord, that I design for you out of clay, a figure like that of a bird, and breathe into it, and it becomes a bird by Allah's leave; and I heal the blind, and the leper, and I bring the dead to life by Allah's leave. And I inform you of what you eat, and what you store in your houses. Surely, therein is a sign for you, if you believe."} 450. "(And I have come) confirming that which was before me of the Taivrdh, and to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you, and I have come to you with a proof from your Lord. So have Taqwd of Allah and obey me."} 451 . “Truly, Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him (Alone). This is the straight path.”}

The Description of ‘Isa and the Miracles He Performed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 860–862]

Allah states that the good news brought to Maryam about ‘Isa was even better because Allah would teach him, 4the Book and Al-Hikmah}. It appears that the ‘Book’ the Ayah mentioned here refers to writing. We explained the meaning of Al-Hikmah in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. 4the Taivrdh and the Injil}. The Tawrah is the Book that Allah sent down to Musa, son of ‘Imran, while the Injil is what Allah sent down to isa, son of Maryam, peace be upon them, and ‘Isa memorized both Books. Allah’s statement, Zip d'. 4And will make him a Messenger to the Children of Israel} means, that Allah will send ‘Isa as a Messenger to the Children of Israel, proclaiming to them, > ..S 41 have come to you with a sign from your Lord, I design for you out of clay, a figure like that of a bird, and breathe into it, and it becomes a bird by Allah's leave}.

These are the miracles that ‘Isa performed; he used to make the shape of a bird from clay and blow into it, and it became a bird by Allah’s leave. Allah made this a miracle for Isa to testify that He had sent him. i \s}j} iAnd I heal him who is Akmah^ meaning, ‘a person who was born blind,’ which perfects this miracle and makes the challenge more daring. iAnd the leper} which is a known disease, / f ,-S \ Up LfJ? iAnd I bring the dead to life by Allah's leave}. Many scholars stated that Allah sent every Prophet with a miracle suitable to his time. For instance, in the time of Musa, magic was the trade of the time, and magicians held a high position. So Allah sent Musa with a miracle that captured the eyes and

bewildered every magician. When the magicians realized that Musa's miracle came from the Almighty, Most Great, they embraced Islam and became pious believers. As for Isa, he was sent during a time when medicine and knowledge in physics were advancing. Isa brought them the types of miracles that could not be performed, except by one sent by Allah. How can any physician bring life to clay, cure blindness and leprosy and bring back to life those entrapped in the grave? Muhammad jg was sent during the time of eloquent people and proficient poets. He brought them a Book from Allah; if mankind and the Jinn tried to imitate ten chapters, or even one chapter of it, they will utterly fail in this task, even if they tried to do it by collective cooperation. This is because the Qur'an is the Word of Allah and is nothing like that of the creatures. Isa's statement. iAnd I inform you of what you eat, and what you store in your houses} means, I tell you about what one of you has just eaten and

165 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) what he is keeping in his house for tomorrow. iSurely, therein}, all these miracles, 4is a sign for you} testifying to the truth of what I was sent to you with, }If you believe. And I have come confirming that which was before me of the Tawrah,} affirming the Tawrah and upholding it, jji j£> fk=o &%>} iand to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you.} This part of the Ayah indicates that 'Isa abrogated some of the Laws of the Tawrah and informed the Jews of the truth

regarding some issues that they used to dispute about. In

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 862–864]

another Ayah; uylbji JaM ^SJ CA>X>r iAnd in order to make clear to you some of the (points) in which you differ} [43:63], Isa said next, iAnd I have come to you with a proof from your Lord.} “Containing affirmation and evidence to the truth of what I am conveying to you.” i'tjxjfc . if) i>[‘.if JjXJlj <&1 iSo have Taqwa of Allah and obey me. Truly, Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him (Alone).} for I and you are equal in our servitude, submission and humbleness to Him, i"£S-U i&} iThis is the straight path.}

266 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ?ri ”22 -0-)> <0>' 3^ ^4 Jli <i(jtiit ^3b £1 it da: C* tsa* c\$.m • *• / j ^ / *<{* Liiisoli Jj^h Lx»uJj cJjft U^=^j £ £- ii& & 452 . Then when Tsd came to know of their disbelief, he said: "Wfw will be my helpers in Allah's cause?" Al-Ha- wdriyyun said: “We are the helpers of Allah; we believe in Allah, and bear witness that we are Muslims.”} 453. "Our Lord! We believe in what You have sent down, and we follow the Messenger [Isa]; so write us down among those who bear witness.”} And they (disbelievers) plotted and Allah planned too. And Allah is the Best of those who plot} The Disciples Give Their Support to 'Isa Allah said, 4Then when Tsd came to know}, meaning, 'Isa felt that they were adamant in disbelief and continuing in misguidance. He said to them, 4Who will be my helper in Allah's cause?} Mujahid commented,

“Meaning, who would follow me to Allah?” ' However, it appears that Isa was asking, “Who would help me convey the Message of Allah?” The Prophet sg said during the Hajy season, before the Hijrah, aAjI jl ai LIj'ji «Who will give me asylum so that / can convey the Speech of my Lord, far the Quraush have prevented me from conveying the Speech of my Lord.»'2 until he found the Ansar.13* The Ansar helped the Prophet sg and gave him refuge. He later migrated to them, they comforted the Prophet sg and protected him from all his enemies, may Allah be pleased with them all. This is similar to what

happened with 'Isa, for some of the Children of Israel believed in him, gave him their aid and support and followed the light that was sent with him. This is why Allah said about them; :r 'S' 1 ' U L-.-l' Uj iAl-Haumriyyun said: "We are the helpers of Allah; we believe in Allah, and bear witness that we are Muslims. Our Lord! We believe in what You have sent dotvn, and we follow the Messenger; so ivrite us down among those who bear witness. ")> Hawari in Arabic - means 'support'. The Two Sahihs recorded that when the Prophet jg encouraged the people to fight during

the battle of Al-Ahzab, Az-Zubayr came forward, and again,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 864–872]

when the Prophet jg asked for fighters a second time. The Prophet sg said, "Every Prophet has a Hawari, and Az-Zubayr is my Hawari^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said about, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 3:290. 121 Ahmad 3 :322 * Al Bidayah wan-Nihayah 5 :140 141 Fath Al-Bari 6 :63 , Muslim 4:1879.

iso zvrite us down among those who bear witness} "Meaning among the Ummah of Muhammad."111 This Hadith has a good chain of narration. The Jews Plot to Kill 'Isa Allah states that the Children of Israel tried to kill Isa by conspiring to defame him and crucify him. They complained about him to the king who was a disbeliever. They claimed that 'Isa was a man who misguided people, discouraged them from obeying the king, caused division, and separated between man and his own son. They also said other lies about 'Isa, which they will cany on their necks, including accusing him of being an illegitimate son. The king became furious and sent his men to capture 'Isa to torture and crucify him. When they surrounded "Isa's home and he thought that they would surely capture him, Allah saved him from them, raising him up from the house to heaven. Allah put the image of Isa on a man who was in the house; when the unjust people went in the house while it was still dark, they thought that he was Isa. They captured that man, humiliated and crucified him. They also placed thorns on his head . However, Allah deceived these people. He saved and raised His Prophet from them, leaving them in disarray in the darkness of their transgression, thinking that they had successfully achieved their goal. Allah made their hearts hard, and defiant of the truth, disgracing them in such disgrace that it will remain with them until the Day of Resurrection. This is why Allah said, iff <i'j ii' iAnd they plotted, and Allah planned too. And Allah is the Best of those who plot.} ^ Some of this story is based on a report from Ibn 'Abbas which appears in the explanation of Surat An-Nisa'no. 156. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :294

ji Gj 4 iff Cfc "iyiliio *_j 4-4 i ijL^j i£sr. ^ji1/jjf lS'j 4 x £isi» o£*5f"i .>• .llx^t. tjc. 455. And (remember) when Allah said: "O 'Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself and purify [save] you from those who disbelieve, and 1 will make those who follow you superior to those who disbelieve till the Day of Resurrection . Then you will return to Me and I will judge between you in the matters in which you used to dispute." 456. "/Vs to those who disbelieve, I will punish them with severe torment in this world and in the Hereafter, and they zwill have no helpers."} 457. And as for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, Allah will pay them their reward in full. And AllSh does not like the lorongdoers . 458 . This is wlwt We recite to you of the verses and the Wise Reminder.} Meaning of 'Take You Allah said, «3< 41 will take you and raise you to Myself} while you are asleep. Allah said in a similar Ayat, 4It is He Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep).} [6:60], and, &+& 4^ J

It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep.} [39:42]. The Messenger of Allah used to recite the following words when he would awaken; 0 GJtj t iiiUl G JOW CG>-I AM JU—Jl

>All the thanks are due to Allah Who brought us back to life after He had caused us to die (sleep), and the Return is to Him*.1' 1 Allah said, '{</ if J-& ^ rt&J *- c&j C*j t>S J>-v 4A«d because of their disbelief and allegations against Maryam and because of their saying "We killed Al-Masdi 'Isa, son of Maryam, the Messenger of Allah," - but they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared that way to them} until, XirthS < - -/'-If "" *•-" '•< Xv^P^~W*" ,^Lrs i fyj ^For surely; they killed him not But Allah raised him up unto Himself. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise. And there is none of the people of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) but must believe in him before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he ['Isa] will be a iivhiess against them.} [4:156- 159] 'His death' refers to Isa, and the Ayah means that the People of the Book will believe in Isa, before Isa dies. This will occur when 'Isa comes back to this world before the Day of Resurrection, as we will explain. By that time, all the People of the Book will believe in Isa, for he will annul the Jizyatf2 ^ and he will only accept Islam from people. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Hasan said that Allah's statement, }I ivill take you} is in reference to sleep, for Allah raised 'Isa while he was asleep. 131 Altering the Religion of 'Isa Allah said, 111 Fath Al-Bari 11:134. ^ A tax levied on non-Muslims living under Muslim control {3} Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :296

iAnd purify [save] you from those who disbelieve} by raising you to heaven, #^ Si I#r Sir ij> iji? Sir / wifl make those who follow you superior to those who disbelieve , till the Day of Resurrection This is what happened. When Allah raised 'Isa to heaven, his followers divided into sects and groups. Some of them believed in what Allah sent Isa as, a servant of Allah, His Messenger, and the son of His female-servant. However, some of them went to the extreme over 'Isa, believing that he was the son of Allah. Some of them said that *Isa was Allah Himself, while others said that he was one of a Trinity. Allah mentioned these false creeds in the Qur'an and refuted them. The Christians remained like this until the third century CE, when a Greek king called, Constantine, became a Christian for the purpose of destroying Christianity. Constantine was either a philosopher, or he was just plain ignorant. Constantine changed the religion of isa by adding to it and deleting from it. He established the rituals of Christianity and the so-called Great Trust, which is in fact the Great Treachery. He also allowed them to eat the meat of swine, changed the direction of the prayer that Isa established to the east, built churches for Isa, and added ten days to the fast as compensation for a sin that he committed, as claimed. So the religion of Isa became the religion of Constantine, who built more than twelve thousand churches, temples and monasteries for the Christians as well as the city that bears his name, Constantinople (Istanbul). Throughout this time, the Christians had the upper hand and dominated the Jews. Allah aided them against the Jews because they used to be closer to the truth than the Jews, even though both groups were and still are disbelievers, may Allah's curse descend on them. When Allah sent Muhammad Us, those who believed in him also believed in Allah, His Angels, Books and Messengers in the correct manner. So they were the true followers of every Prophet who came to earth. They believed in the unlettered Prophet sg, the Final Messenger and the master of all mankind,

who called them to believe in the truth in its entirety. This is why they had more right to every Prophet than his own nation, especially those who claim to follow their Prophet's way and religion, yet change and alter his religion. Furthermore, Allah abrogated all the laws that were sent down to the Prophets with the Law He sent Muhammad jg with, which consists of the true religion that shall never change or be altered until the commencement of the Last Hour. Muhammad's religion shall always be dominant and victorious over all other religions. This is why Allah allowed Muslims to conquer the eastern and western parts of the world and the kingdoms of the earth. Furthermore, all countries submitted to them; they demolished Kisra (king of Persia) and destroyed the Czar, ridding them of their treasures and spending these treasures for Allah's sake. All this occurred just as their Prophet jg told them it would, when he conveyed Allah's statement, *Ljr=> j .Li i \JEC cyft iif J ^ £ t; ; p. £\$ >&> p oj dUp iAlldh* has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before them, and that He will grant them the authority to practice their religion luhich He has chosen for them. And He will surely give them in exchange a safe security after their fear (provided) they worship Me and do not associate anything with Me.\$ [24:55). Therefore, Muslims are the true believers in 'Isa. The Muslims then acquired Ash-Sham from the Christians, causing them to evacuate to Asia Minor, to their fortified city in Constantinople. The Muslims will be above them until the Day of Resurrection. Indeed, he, Muhammad sfe, who is truthful and who received the true news, has conveyed to Muslims that they will conquer Constantinople in the future, and seize its treasures. *** This occured after ibn Kathlr's time.

Threatening the Disbelievers with Torment in This Life and the Hereafter Allah said, *\ij J 4 C/jJ' C*fc « w £-> 4r>' .ikf-i Ji >-+! 4And / w*7/ make those zvho follow you superior to those who disbelieve till the Day of Resurrection . Then you will return to Me and I will judge between you in the matters in which you used to dispute. As to those who disbelieve, I will punish them with a severe torment in this world and in the Hereafter, and they will have no helpers. This is what Allah did to the Jews who disbelieved in isa and the Christians who went to the extreme over him. Allah tormented them in this life; they were killed, captured, and lost their wealth and kingdoms. Their torment in the Hereafter is even worse and more severe, Vi oj iAnd they have no Wdq (defender or protector) against Allah} [13 : 34], s 4^*4^' 'Ji »'''£> iyit* j'fi iAnd as for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, Allah ivill pay them their reward in full} in this life, with victory and domination, and in the Hereafter, with Paradise and high grades, i4i y '^j} iAnd Allah does not like the wrongdoers.} Allah then said, o'# Sj #>} iThis is what We recite to you of the verses and the Wise Reminder.} meaning, "What We narrated to you, O Muhammd, regarding Isa, his birth and his life, is what Allah conveyed and revealed*

*m oA to you, sent down J 3>jt \ C^1 LJ^j otaijS_yjli \1>1> '_«1^j.-M i_>!_yL» 'j3_yuli LSuu yaUj-vujWi \$ ^iii^ from the Al-Lawh Al- M a h f u z (The Preserved Tablet). So there is no doubt in it. Similarly, Allah said in Surah Maryam-, , 4j ^ f-A cj) JAi l> ,'.HvLitA*i AJ i£j)l (jhJI < J , y -J> dr5 o' (jo 4& G£ £1 *2 fil i^m jr \$ iSuch is 'Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a state- ment of truth, about which they doubt (or dispute). It befits not Allah that He should beget a son . Glorified be He. When He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be!" and it is. } iS*J' f jfZj jf 'A JU i y'J cri ^2°- fS'» ,(i' if ,\rt* ji £9 'jft2 jia £ fi £ *~» ££& ji ."•.SiH)' Vi «i&j oi JI _*l' oii) fi—M'j L^jJj ficly* iTaijj jSYG^J tTitH.1 j^jj* «>' -iv'j *>>' V^ fj) Oi Ei«)' .j IJca o(" ojJisa)' 4 w . jf-j.-iili %Ac <il' 5U 'j3jj 459. Verily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then said to him: "Be!" and he*

was.} 460. (This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt.} 461 . Then whoever disputes with you concerning him after the

175 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves, then we pray and we invoke Allah's curse upon the liars."} 462. Verily, this is the true narrative, and there is no god except Allah. And indeed, Allah is the Almighty, the All- Wise.} 463 . And if they turn away, then surely, Allah is All-Aware of those who do mischief.} The Similarities Between the Creation of Adam and the Creation of 'Isa Allah said, iVerily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah}

regarding Allah's ability, since He created him without a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 872–887]

father, 4is the likeness of Adam}, for Allah created Adam without a father or a mother. Rather, 4#3 \$ i ft J-i '-fj ot 4He created him from dust, then (He) said to him : "Be!" and he was.} Therefore, He Who created Adam without a father or a mother is able to create 'Isa, as well, without a father. If the claim is made that 'Isa is Allah's son because he was created without a father, then the same claim befits Adam even more. However, since such a claim regarding Adam is obviously false, then making the same claim about 'Isa is even more false. Furthermore, by mentioning these facts, Allah emphasizes His ability, by creating Adam without a male or female, Hawa' from a male without a female, and Isa from a mother without a father, compared to His creating the rest of creation from male and female. This is why Allah said in Surah Maryam,

4oz& ij'* ;a&<4j} iAttd We made him a sign for mankind} [19:21]. Allah said in this Ayah, i : *& 3 \$5 i(This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt.} meaning, this is the only true story about Isa, and what is beyond truth save falsehood? Allah next commands His Messenger to call those who defy the truth, regarding Isa, to the Mubahalah (the curse). The Challenge to the Mubahalah b.tjj fit 'jjbi jii jfjf U frt [jA <ui liU-t fCt} iTheit whoever disputes with you concerning him after the knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves"} for the Mubahalah, ^then we pray}, supplicate, d* vlvJ iand we invoke Allah's curse upon the liars} among the two of us.

The reason for the call to Mubahalah and the revelation of the Ayat from the beginning of this Surah until here, is that a delegation from the Christians of Najran (in Yemen) came to Al-Madinah to argue about Isa, claiming that he was divine and the son of Allah. Allah sent down the beginning of this Surah until here, to refute their claims, as Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar and other scholars stated. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said in his famous Sirah, "The delegation of Christians from Najran came to the Messenger of Allah The delegation consisted of sixty horsemen, including fourteen of their chiefs who make

decisions. These men were Al-'Aqib, also known as 'Abdul- Masfh, As-Sayyid, also known as Al-Ayham, Abu Harithah bin 'Alqamah, of (the family of] Bakr bin Wa'il and Uways bin Al- Harith. They also included, Zayd, Qays, Yazld, Nablh, Khuwaylid, 'Amr, Khalid, 'Abdullah and Yuhannas. Three of these men were chiefs of this delegation, Al-'Aqib, their leader and to whom they referred for advice

and decision; As-Sayyid, their scholar and leader in journeys and social gatherings; and Abu Harithah bin 'Alqamah, their patriarch, priest and religious leader. Abu Harithah was an Arab man from (the family of) Bakr bin Wa'il, but when he embraced Christianity, the Romans and their kings honored him and built churches for him (or in his honor). They also supported him financially and gave him servants, because they knew how firm his faith in their religion was." Abu Harithah knew the description of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ from what he read in earlier divine Books. However, his otherwise ignorance led him to insist on remaining a Christian, because he was honored and had a high position with the Christians. Ibn Ishaq said, "Muhammad bin Ja'far bin Az-Zubayr said that, The (Najran) delegation came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ in Al-Madīnah, entered his Masjid wearing robes and garments, after the Prophet ﷺ had prayed the 'Asr prayer. They accompanied a caravan of camels led by Bani Al-Harith bin Kah. The Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who saw them said that they never saw a delegation like them after that... Then Abu Harithah bin 'Alqamah and Al-'Aqib 'Abdul-Masih or As-Sayyid Al-Ayham spoke to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and they were Christians like the king (Roman King). However, they disagreed about Isa; some of them said, 'He is Allah,' while some said, 'He is the son of Allah,' and some others said, 'He is one of a trinity.' Allah is far from what they attribute to Him." Indeed, these are the creeds of the Christians. They claim that Isa is God, since he brought the dead back to life, healed blindness, leprosy and various illnesses, told about matters of the future, created the shape of birds and blew life into them, bringing them to life. However, all these miracles occurred by 111 Ibn Hisham 2:222.

178 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah's leave, so that Isa would be a sign from Allah for people. They also claim that Isa is the son of Allah, since he did not have a father and he spoke when he was in the cradle, a miracle which had not occurred by any among the Children of Adam before him, so they claim. They also claim that Isa is one of a trinity, because Allah would say, *We did, command, create and demand.' They said, 'If Allah were one, he would have said, I did, command, create and decide.' This is why they claim that Isa and Allah are one (Trinity). Allah is far from what they attribute to Him, and we should mention that the Qur'an refuted all these false Christian claims. Ibn Ishaq continued, "When these Aydt came to the Messenger from Allah ﷺ, thus judging between him and the People of the Book, Allah also commanded the Prophet ﷺ to call them to the Mubalahah if they still refused the truth. The Prophet ﷺ called them to the Mubalahah. They said, 'O Abu Al-Qasim! Let us think about this matter and get back to you with our decision to what we want to do.' They left the Prophet ﷺ and conferred with Al-'Aqib, to whom they referred to for advice. They said to him, 'O 'Abdul-Masih! What is your advice?' He said, 'By Allah, O Christian fellows! You know that Muhammad is a Messenger and that he brought you the final word regarding your fellow (Isa). You also know that no Prophet conducted Mubalahah with any people, and the old persons among them remained safe and the young people grew up. Indeed, it will be the end of you if you do it. If you have already decided that you will remain in your religion and your creed regarding your fellow (Isa), then conduct a treaty with the man (Muhammad) and go back to your land.' They came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, 'O Abu Al-Qasim! We decided that we cannot do Mubalahah with you and that you remain on your religion, while we remain on our religion. However, send with us a man from your Companions whom you are pleased with to judge between us regarding our monetary disputes, for you are acceptable to us in this regard.'" Al-

Bukhari recorded that Hudhayfah said, “Al-‘Aqib and As- Sayyid, two leaders from Najran, came to the Messenger of m Ibn Hisham 2 :233.

Allah s£ seeking to invoke Allah for curses (against whoever is unjust among them), and one of them said to the other, ‘Let us not do that. By Allah, if he were truly a Prophet and we invoke Allah for curses, we and our offspring shall never succeed afterwards.’ So they said, *We will give you what you asked and send a trusted man with us, just a trusted man.’ The Messenger of Allah sS said; J IgJ -J 0??^ ^* ajub ‘^1 lJl&® <U)t (Jy*IJ JU fc fU Zji ^ a"Verily, I xoill send a trusted man with you, a truly trustworthy man.” The Companions of the Messenger of Allah \$S all felt eager to be that man. The Messenger jife said, "O Abu 'Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrdh! Stand up.” When Abu 'Ubaydah stood up, the Messenger of Allah said, "This is the trustee of this Ummah .' "»I1) Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas said that the Messenger Allah jg said on another occasion, C' of «Every Ummah has a trustee, and the trustee of this Ummah is Abu 'Ubaydah bin Al-jarrdh .»|21 Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, said, “If I see Muhammad praying next to the Ka'bah, I will step on his neck.’ The Prophet later said, Ijljj v k UUjP Aj ft «Had he tried to do it, the angels would have taken him publicly. Had the Jeios wished for death, they would have perished and would have seen their seats in the Fire. Had those who sought Mubdhalah with the Messenger of Allah, as, went ahead with it, they would not have found estates or families 111 Fath Al-Bari 7 :695 I2 ' Fath Al-Bari 7 :696

180 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr when they returned Al-Bukhan, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa'i^ also recorded this Hadith, which At-Tirmidhi graded Hasan Sahih. Allah then said, 4 J*J' J' iVerily, this is the true narrative meaning, what we narrated to you, O Muhammad, about ‘Isa is the plain truth that cannot be avoided, ity* 4 &% *ii iand none has the right to be worshipped but Allah. And indeed, Allah is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise. And if they tum away,} by abandoning this truth, Lilt J ^ 4then surely, Allah is All-Aware of those who do mischief.} for those who abandon the truth for falsehood commit mischief, and Allah has full knowledge of them and will subject them to the worst punishment. Verily, Allah is able to control everything, all praise and thanks are due to Him, and we seek refuge with Him from His revenge. /, < -i* 4^ Hi '-i\ H[U H\ £z'i cdz .p ip=> di ppf >b; 'jijJ 0^ OJJ J* b— jip Vj Pipi 464. Sfily: "O people of the Scripture: Come to a ivord that is just between us and you, that we worship none but Allah the same, and that we associate no partners with Him, and that none of us shall take others as lords besides Allah." Then, if they turn away, say: "Bear witness that we arc Muslims."} Every Person Knows about Tawhid This Ayah includes the People of the Book, the Jews and Christians, and those who follow their ways. Ahmad 1 :248 Fath Al-Bari 8 :595, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :77, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra

if4^=* & *#2 Ji0 ji> ^Say : "O people of the Scripture! Come to a word"} ‘Word’ - in Arabic - also means a complete sentence, as evident from this Ayah. Allah described this word as being one, itliat is the same between us and you}, an honest and righteous word that is fair to both parties. Allah then explained this word, i'k^ . **_. 'jj y\t Zll ithat we worship none but Allah (Alone), and that we associate no partners with Him,} we worship neither a statue, cross, idol, Taghut (false gods), fire or anything else. Rather, we worship Allah Alone without partners, and this is the message of all of Allah’s Messengers. Allah said, ^ t' *S/ 1 Jd] Jo" O] z&y yj. Jj-y dji* & Z',} iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I

(Allah)], so worship Me (Alone and none else)."} [21:25] and, Vj-J Ail J.<r=> j, jjJj} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid (or keep away from) Taghut (all false deities)."} [16:36]. Allah said next, i flit 05> liljl L*uu bwvuj JitLj Vj> i"and that none of us shall take others as lords besides Allah."} Ibn Jurayj commented, "We do not obey each other in disobedience to Allah." id 4\$ iThen, if they turn away, say: "Bear witness that we are Muslims."}

182 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir if they abandon this fair call, then let them know that you will remain in Islam as Allah has legislated for you. We should mention that the letter that the Prophet *ṣ* sent to Heraclius reads, "In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. From Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah, to Heraclius, Leader of the Romans: peace be upon those who follow the true guidance. Embrace Islam and you will acquire safety, embrace Islam and Allah will grant you a double reward. However, if you turn away from it, then you will carry the burden of the peasants, and, people of the Scripture: Come to a word that is the same between us and you, that we worship none but Allah (Alone), and that we associate no partners with Him, and that none of us shall take others as lords besides Allah." Then, if they turn away, say: "Bear witness that we are Muslims."y Muhammad bin Ishaq and other scholars said that the beginning of Surah Al 'Imran, and more than eighty verses thereafter; were revealed about the delegation of Najran. Az- Zuhri stated that the people of Najran were the first people to pay the Jizyah (tax money paid to the Muslim State). However, there is no disagreement that the Ayah that ordained the Jizyah [9:29] was revealed after the Fath (conquering Makkah, and therefore, after the delegation of Najran came to Al- Madīnah). So, how can this Ayah [3:64] be contained in the Prophet's letter to Heraclius before the victory of Makkah, and how can we harmonize between the statements of Muhammad bin Ishaq and Az-Zuhri? The answer is that the delegation of Najran came before Al-Hudaybiyyah (before the victory of Makkah), and what they paid was in lieu of the Mubalahah, not as Jizyah. The Ayah about the Jizyah was later revealed, and its ruling supported what occurred with the Najran people. In support of this opinion, we should mention that in another instance, the ruling on dividing the booty into one - fifth (for the Prophet *ṣ*) and four-fifths (for the fighters) agreed with the practice of 'Abdullah bin Jahsh during the raid that he led before Badr. An Ayah later on upheld the way 'Abdullah

divided the booty. Therefore, it is possible that the Prophet *ṣ* wrote this statement (Say, "O People of the Scripture...") in his letter to Heraclius before the Ayah was revealed. Later on, the Qur'an agreed with the Prophet's statement, word by word. It is also a fact that the Qur'an was revealed in agreement with what 'Umar said regarding the captured disbelievers at Badr, the Hijab (Muslim woman code of dress), refraining from performing prayer for the hypocrites, and regarding his statements: 4And take you the Maqdm (place) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer.} [2:125], and, x/ \ Cs^r ilt may be if he divorced you (all) that his Lord will give him instead of you, wives better than you.} [66:5]. % pe pQ 2Z& uj-l: cjS* f 'J7> d V Cfifj iff ly-f' i/fd oi^ t*J 4 kij <*> 465. O people of the Scripture! Why do you dispute about Ibrahim, while the Tawrah and the Injil were not revealed till after him? Have you then no sense?} 466. Verily, you are those who have disputed about that of which you have no knowledge. Why do you then dispute concerning that of which you have no knowledge? It is Allah *W*lw knows, and you know not.} 467 . Ibrahim was neither a Jew nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifa and he was not of the Mushrikin } 468. Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are

those who followed him, and this Prophet and those who have believed. And Allah is the Wali (Protector and Helper) of the believers

184 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Disputing with the Jews and Christians About the Religion of Ibrahim Allah censures the Jews and Christians for their dispute with Muslims over Ibrahim Al-Khalil and the claim each group made that he was one of them. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Christians of Najran and Jewish rabbis gathered before the Messenger of Allah sfe, and disputed in front of him. The rabbis said, Ibrahim was certainly Jewish.’ The Christians said, ‘Certainly, Ibrahim was Christian.’ So Allah sent down, 40 people of the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Why do you dispute about Ibrahim,} meaning, *How is it that you, Jews, claim that Ibrahim was Jew, although he lived before Allah sent down the Tawrah to Musa? How is it that you, Christians, claim that Ibrahim was Christian, although Christianity came after his time?” This is why Allah said, iHave you then no sense?} Allah then said, k ‘*i («£• S4 \$ pi ‘ti iVerily, you are those who have disputed about that of which you have knowledge. Why do you then dispute concerning that ofwhich you have no knowledge?} This Ayah criticizes those who argue and dispute without knowledge, just as the Jews and Christians did concerning Ibrahim. Had they disputed about their religions, which they had knowledge of, and about the Law that was legislated for them until Muhammad was sent, it would have been better for them. Rather, they disputed about what they had no knowledge of, so Allah criticized them for this behavior. Allah commanded them to refer what they have no knowledge of to He Who knows the seen and unseen matters and Who knows [>] At-Tabari 6 :490

185Siirah 3. Al ‘Imran (Part-3 the true reality of all things. This is why Allah said, ill is Allah Who knows, and you knoio not.) Allah said, /*/ »A £ <.) ilbrdhim was neither a Jezv nor a Christian, but he was a true Muslim Hanifa j», shunning Shirk and living in Iman, 4S£iS ^ o*’ }and he zoas not of the Mushrikin .} This Ayah is similar to the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, iAnd they say, "Be Jeivs or Christians, then you will be guided..." (2:135]. Allah said next, 4-V'ia iij L~** iff ijv' -^1^ 4 Verily, among mankind zuho have the best claim to Ibrahim are those zvho followed him, and this Prophet and those who have believed. And Allah is the Wali (Protector and Helper) of the believers.) This Ayah means, “The people who have the most right to be followers of Ibrahim are those who followed his religion and this Prophet, Muhammad jg, and his Companions from the Muhajirin, Ansar and those who followed their lead.” Said bin Mansur recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, •Every Prophet had a Wali (supporter, best friend) from among the Prophets. My Wali among them is my father Ibrahim, the Khalil (intimate friend) of my Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored» The Prophet jg then recited, Sjj jj' d>\}

'LW\‘ e JDSUBW u?q P1.BS m 4,/ssaufm waq nob aptfcn 'i{P}lvf° ivby ai{} ui aoatpqsip nob op bi{M pjttfduas aip fo a\doaj o,, OzV 4)ou aapajad baip pitv 'sanjasuatp fdaaxa auobnv bvjjsv pvaj jou \vip baip jng bvjpv nob pva\ o; tjsoi auniduag aig fo apioag aig fo bpvd y jpr*":\$:^ V if if* f ^ *? !>s fj£ v iet f, f. H jit«? rrr if f^ C5^ a^ f ft# £*• £ >5 isEl ?*fi^ ?rfi rrr >(&f \$jss vff. ^5-S -f- ^ f?ir' 5\V» ? i*f* it\$:r' rrve^c ifwP firr*’ <*n^(n< »A «-»> 'Jr* /r :r:’ irsr d <r£ ir^ *Kf l!5r d SJ57 ?^ if HE# 2a f fit »^ & 4-F S c* if^r •siaSuassajM sih ui SAdipq oqm asoqj ns jo JOpajOJd aqU si M?[iv ‘sueaui 4 sjaoaipq aip fo (uadpiq puv jopaiouj) Jim 3lll st iffUV P<V i%% itffit ‘juauiajejs s,qenv (I I 4" mi{ paowjjof oipi

asoiiji aw unifvuqj 0) wtvp fsaq ai{} aavij oipi pitt)fUVUl Suouw ‘bjU3^ £> Wll»yi ttqi uisfvx ^>0%
iff*\$ \$ ^ tans vo swaas ^

187Surah 3 . Al ‘Imran (Part-3) 471. "O People of the Scripture! Why do you mix truth with falsehood and conceal the truth ivhile you know?"} 472. And a party of the People of the Scripture say: "Believe in the morning in that which is revealed to the believers, and reject it at the end of the day, so that they may turn back.} 473. And believe no one except the one who follcnos your religion." Say (O Prophet): "Verily , right guidance is the guidance of Allah." (And they say:) "Do not believe that anyone can receive like that which you have received, otherwise they would engage you in argument before your Lord." Say: "All the bounty is in the Hand of Allah; He grants to whom He wills. And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Knower."} 474. He selects for His Mercy whom He wills and Allah is the Oioner ofgreat bounty.} TheEnvytheJews FeelTowardsMuslims; TheirWicked Plots Against Muslims Allah states that the Jews envy the faithful and wish they could misguide them. Allah states that the punishment of this behavior will fall back upon them, while they are unaware. Allah criticizes them, 40 People of the Scripture! : Why do you disbelieve in the Ayat ofAllah, while you bear ivitness.} You know for certain that Allah’s Ayat are true and authentic, 40 People of the Scripture: Why do you mix truth with falsehood and conceal the truth while you know? } by hiding what is in your Books about the description of Muhammad sg, while you know what you do. ©ft 4fec 4And a party of the People of the Scripture say : "Believe in the morning in that which is revealed to the believers, and reject it

at the end of the day,} This is a wicked plan from the People of the Book to deceive Muslims who are weak in the religion. They decided that they would pretend to be believers in the beginning of the day, by attending the dawn prayer with the Muslims. However, when the day ended, they would revert to their old religion so that the ignorant people would say, “They reverted to their old religion because they uncovered some shortcomings in the Islamic religion.” This is why they said next. ^so that they may turn back Ibn Abi Najih said that Mujahid commented about this Ayah, which refers to the Jews, “They attended the dawn prayer with the Prophet and disbelieved in the end of the day in order to misguide the people. This way, people would think that they have uncovered shortcomings in the religion that they briefly followed.”111 C?-* o-i 4"And believe no one except theonewhofollows your religion." 4 They said, do not trust anyone with your secret knowledge, except those who follow your religion. Therefore, they say, do not expose your knowledge to Muslims in order to prevent them from believing in it and, thus, use it as proof against you. Allah replied, jty 4Say: (O Prophet) "Verily, right guidance is the guidance of Allah."} Allah guides the hearts of the faithful to the perfect faith through the clear Ayat, plain proofs and unequivocal evidence that He has sent down to His servant and Messenger Muhammad This occurs, O you Jews, even though you hide the description ofMuhammad jfe. the unlettered Prophetwhom you find in your Books that you received from the earlier Prophets. Allah’s statement; j' Vk jil uj\ city m At-Tabari 6 :508

4(And they say:) "Do not believe that anyone can receive like that which you have received, otherwise they would engage you in argument before your Lord."} They say, “Do not disclose the knowledge that you have to the Muslims, to prevent them from learning it and thus becoming your equals. They will be even better because they will believe in it or will use it against you as evidence with your Lord, and

thus establish Allah's proof against you in this life and the Hereafter." Allah said, 4*^ o' <-i\$. k 4Say : "All the bounty is in the Hand of Allah ; He grants to whom He wills.} meaning, all affairs are under His control, and He gives and takes. Verily, Allah gives faith, knowledge and sound comprehension to whomever He wills. He also misguides whomever He wills by blinding his sight, mind, seeding his heart, hearing and stamping his eyes closed. Allah has the perfect wisdom and the unequivocal proofs. j's% si*& y%} 4And Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower." He selects for His mercy whom He wills and Allah is the Owner of great bounty.} meaning, He has endowed you, O believers, with tremendous virtue, in that He honored your Prophet Muhammad gs over all other prophets, and by directing you to the best Sharfah there is. 'i J&Jt ol JUi i.Sjj yllii iLt ol £ J-cv* ossf&ft 4 U 4 ,vl,Jvilisf v-i4 tif jlij 475. Among the People of the Scripture is he who, if entrusted with a Qintar (a great amount of wealth), will readily pay it back; and among them there is he who, if entrusted with a single silver coin, will not repay it unless you constantly stand demanding, because they say: "There is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs)." But

190 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr they tell a lie against Allah while they know it.} i76. Yes, whoever fulfills his pledge and fears Allah much; verily, then Allah loves the Muttaqîn (the pious).} How Trustworthy Are the Jews? Allah states that there are deceitful people among the Jews. He also warns the faithful against being deceived by them, because some of them, if entrusted with a Qintar (a great amount)} of money, if they readily pay it back;} This Ayah indicates that this type would likewise give what is less than a Qintar, as is obvious. However, 4 *4* xii'k ^ o) b* jkki'i} iand among them there is he who, if entrusted with a single silver coin, will not repay it unless you constantly stand demanding,} and insisting on acquiring your rightful property. If this is what he would do with one Dinar, then what about what is more than a Dinar? We mentioned the meaning of Qintar in

the beginning of this Surah, while the value of Dinar is well

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 887–935]

known. Allah's statement, 4J : */'" * 4 ££ 4because they say : "There is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs)."} means, what made them reject the truth (or what they owed) is that they said, "There is no harm in our religion if we eat up the property of the unlettered ones, the Arabs, for Allah has allowed it for us." Allah replied, 4^jJU \$ jk Ykj}>yuj} iBut they tell a lie against Allah while they know it.} for they invented this lie and word of misguidance. Rather, Allah would not allow this money for them unless they had a right to it.

197 Surah 3 . Al Imran (Part-3) 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Sa'sa'ah bin Yazîd said that a man asked Ibn 'Abbas, "During battle, we capture some property belonging to Ahl Adh-Dhimmah such as chickens and sheep." Ibn 'Abbas said, "What do you do in this case?" The man said, "We say that there is no sin (if we confiscate them) in this case." He said, "That is what the People of the Book said, Aj^ SsfVf 4 £} iTIt is no blame on us to betray and take the properties of the illiterates (Arabs).} Verily, if they pay the Jizyah, then you are not allowed their property, except when they willingly give it up."*2 Allah then said, AYes, whoever fulfills his pledge and fears Allah much,} fulfills his promise and fears Allah among you, O People of the Book, regarding the covenant Allah took from you to believe in Muhammad sg when he is sent, just as He took the same covenant from all Prophets and their nations.

Whoever avoids Allah's prohibitions, obeys Him and adheres to the Shari'ah that He sent with His Final Messenger and the master of all mankind. 4 > Verily, then Allah loves the Muttaqin.} Yj 4 (*4* <3^ ^ uLj jif ojjs <'w U} ^V&& % '4\ 477. Verily, those who purchase a small gain at the cost of Allah's covenant and their oaths, they shall have no portion in the Hereafter (Paradise). Neither will Allah speak to them nor look at them on the Day of Resurrection, nor will He purify them, and tlmj shall have a painful torment.} Jews and Christians living under Muslim control. Tafsir 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 : 123.

192 Tafstr Ibn Kathir There is No Share in the Hereafter for Those Who Break Allah's Covenant Allah states that whoever prefers the small things of this short, soon to end life, instead of fulfilling what they have promised Allah by following Muhammad 53, announcing his description [from their books] to people and affirming his truth, then. Ax>-*?' 4\$& -5 ithey shall have no portion in the Hereafter.\$ They will not have a share or part in the Hereafter's rewards, AY'-xY fji (*1^ 'ix} ANeither will Allah speak to them nor look at them on the Day of Resurrection } with His mercy. This Ayah indicates that Allah will not speak words of kindness nor look at them with any mercy, Anor will He purify them} from sins and impurities. Rather, He will order them to the Fire, iU Aand they shall have a painful torment.} There are several Hadiths on the subject of this Ayah, some of which follow. The First Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said, AH- j , y_ 'jj ^ 'jj ,4)1 ^ fl L aZjJl* j ,) Jli toljA *There are three persons whom Allah will not speak to, look at on the Day of Resurrection or purify, and they shall taste a painful torment. I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Who are they, may they gain failure and loss?' He said, repeating this

193 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-3) statement thrice, 'The Musbil (man whose clothes reach below the ankles), he who swears while lying so as to sell his merchandise and the one who gives charity and reminds people of it).'»W This was also recorded by Muslim, and the collectors of the Sunnm.12 ' Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Adi bin 'Amlrah Al-Kindi said, "Imru' Al-Qays bin 'Abis, a man from Kindah, disputed with a man from Hadramut in front of the Messenger of Allah sg concerning a piece of land. The Prophet sg required the man from Hadramut to present his evidence, but he did not have any. The Prophet jg required Imru' Al-Qays to swear to his truthfulness, but the man from Hadramut said, 'O Messenger of Allah! If you only require him to swear, then by the Lord of the Ka'bah (Allah), my land is lost.' The Messenger of Allah sg said, j*-j y- «»' ^ jrv. j > , % - "Whoever swears while lying to acquire the property of others, will meet Allah while He is angry/ with him Raja' one of the narrators of the Hadith, said that the Messenger of Allah 5g then recited, 4 Verily, those who purchase a small gain at the cost of Allah's covenant and their oaths... 4 Imru' Al-Qays said, 'What if one forfeits this dispute, what will he gain, O Messenger of Allah?' The Prophet sg answered, "Paradise.' Imru' Al-Qays said, 'Bear witness that I forfeit all the land for him.'""*31 An-Nasa'i also recorded this HadithJ4 Ahmad 5 :148. ^ Muslim 1 :102, Abu Dawud 4:346, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:401 , An- NasaT 7 :245 , Ibn Majah 2 :744 Ahmad 4:191 ' An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 3 :486

Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah \$g said. "y. ^ , 4^ j* j*1 * ^ ^ j J ajL-oi- J4-J «VWioet?er Mes a false oath to deprive a Muslim of his property will meet Allah while He is angry with him .» Al-Ash'ath said, "By Allah! This verse was revealed concerning me. I owned some land with a Jewish man who denied my right, and I complained against

him to the Messenger of Allah. The Prophet ﷺ asked me, 'Do you have evidence?' I said, 'I don't have evidence.' He said to the Jew, 'Take an oath then.' I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! He will take a (false) oath immediately, and I will lose my property.' Allah revealed the verse, 'Verily, those who purchase a small gain at the cost of Allah's covenant and their oaths...'

The Two Sahih recorded this Hadith. Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, - 'Three persons whom Allah shall not speak to on the Day of Resurrection, or look at, or purify them, and they shall taste a painful torment. (They are) a man who does not give the wayfarer some of the water that he has; a man who swears, while lying, in order to complete a sales transaction after the 'Asr prayer; and a man who gives his pledge of allegiance to an Ahmad 1 :379. Fath Al-Bari 5 :336 , Muslim 1 : 122

195 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3) p*3 '•^f^pjkd>Q\$£,22&l£ \$ ZppZfi <£+.&£-&!tet30# 0 j«E&aijs Ojy«- li' |JL-Lit74l A-til gjtgu Imam (Muslim Ruler), and if the Imam gives him (something), he fulfills the pledge, but if the Imam does not give him, he does not fulfill the pledge*. Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi 12 ' also recorded this Hadith, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Hasan Sahth. C)£u li>> I s-t~i Oi >>; Z Cj ,..-^i' * s' \ If ^ ji y o&mj v^ ilJLj 4j»i JC* ^ J* «it 4*£it ,-Ji' ^ .YA ,C)jJLm r*J 47S. And verily, among them is a party who distort the Book with their tongues, so that you may think it is from the Book, but it is not from the Book, and they say: "This is from Allah," but it is not from Allah; and they speak a lie against Allah while they know it. \$ The Jews Alter Allah's Words Allah states that some Jews, may Allah's curses descend on them, distort Allah's Words with their tongues, change them from their appropriate places, and alter their intended meanings. They do this to deceive the ignorant people by making it appear that their words are in the Book of Allah. Ahmad 2:480. ^ Abu Dawud 3 :749 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5:218.

196 Tafsir Ibn Kathir They attribute their own lies to Allah, even though they know that they have lied and invented falsehood. Therefore, Allah said, & zgx jSf& iattd they speak a lie against Allah while they know it.} Mujahid, Ash-ShaTji, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ar-RabI' bin Anas said that, iwho distort the Book with their tongues,} means, "They alter them (Allah's Words). Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah means they alter and add although none among Allah's creation can remove the Words of Allah from His Books, they alter and distort their apparent meanings. Wahb bin Munabbih said, "The Tawrah and the Injil remain as Allah revealed them, and no letter in them was removed. However, the people misguide others by addition and false interpretation, relying on books that they wrote themselves. Then, 4^wi ^ i j* //>\$£*} it they say: "This is from Allah/" but it is not from Allah;} As for Allah's Books, they are still preserved and cannot be changed." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement. However, if Wahb meant the books that are currently in the hands of the People of the Book, then we should state that there is no doubt that they altered, distorted, added to and deleted from them. For instance, the Arabic versions of these books contain tremendous error, many additions and deletions and enormous misinterpretation. Those who rendered these translations have incorrect comprehension in most, rather, all of these translations. If Wahb meant the Books of Allah that He has with Him, then indeed, these Books are preserved and were never changed. 4 tfjr^ j>; p j&Jf; ^ sf c} hi Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :36 1

4>,\$A2^ HS jSCiv. ^ 2^8 |&£ JS^ 479. It is not (possible) for any human being to whom Allah has given the Book and Al-Hukm and prophethood to say to the people: "Be my worshippers rather than Allah's." On the contrary (he would say): "Be you Rabbaniyyun, because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it."} 480. Nor would he order you to take angels and Prophets for lords. Would he order you to disbelieve after you have submitted to Allah's will?} No Prophet Ever Called People to Worship him or to Worship OtherThan Allah This Ayah [3:79] means, it is not for a person whom Allah has given the Book, knowledge in the Law and prophethood to proclaim to the people, "Worship me instead of Allah," meaning, along with Allah. If this is not the right of a Prophet or a Messenger, then indeed, it is not the right of anyone else to issue such a claim. This criticism refers to the ignorant rabbis, priests and teachers of misguidance, unlike the Messengers and their sincere knowledgeable followers who implement their knowledge; for they only command what Allah commands them, as their honorable Messengers conveyed to them. They also forbid what Allah forbade for them, by the words of His honorable Messengers. The Messengers, may Allah's peace and blessings be on all of them, are the emissaries between Allah and His creation, conveying Allah's Message and Trust. The messengers indeed fulfilled their mission, gave sincere advice to creation and conveyed the truth to them. Allah's statement, if Si 40n the contrary (he would say), "Be you Rabbaniyyun, because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it."} means, the Messenger recommends the people to be Rabbaniyyun. Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Razln and several others said that Rabbaniyyun means, "Wise, learned, and forbearing."111 Ibn Abi HStim 2 :365

Ad-Dahhak commented concerning Allah's statement. i&jl^ ^ c,} 4because you are teaching the Book, and you are studying it. } "Whoever learns the Qur'an deserves to become a Faqih (learned)." 4j£>j-£ &£} iand you are studying it}, preserving its words. Allah then said, \$0 Z&s (&£ at pjK, Tj} iNor would he order you to take angels and Prophetsfor lords.} The Prophet does not command worshipping other than Allah, whether a sent Messenger or an angel. & H-M iWould he order you to disbelieve after you have submitted to Allah's will?} meaning, he would not do that, for whoever calls to worshipping other than Allah, will have called to Kufr. The Prophets only call to Iman which commands worshipping Allah Alone without partners. Allah said in other Ayat, 4' Tt 0 V) 4) V Joi VII iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad jg) but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me".} (21:25], 4%£&\ SV& ^ 1^ I * } * ^ V iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit (all false deities)." (16:36], and, i+JJ. oji Of Of Of £ j£j} iAnd ask those of Our Messengers whom We sent before you: "Did We ever appoint gods to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious (Allah)?" [43:45] Allah said concerning the angels,

iSj* jX <?yr oi pri & <yj 4And if any of them should say : "Verily, I am a god besides Him (Allah)," such a one We should recompense with Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers (21:29). 481. And (remember) when Allah took the covenant of the Prophets, saying: "Take whatever I gave you from the Book and Hikmah, and afterwards there will come to you a Messenger confirming what is with you; you must, then, believe in him and help him." Allah said: "Do you agree (to it) and will you take up Isri?" They said: "We agree." He said: "Then bear witness; and I am with you among the witnesses."y 482. Then whoever turns away after this, they are the rebelliousy Taking a Pledge From the Prophets to Believe in Our Prophet,Muhammadm Allah states that He took a pledge from every Prophet whom He

sent from Adam until Isa, that when Allah gives them the Book and the Hikmah, thus acquiring whatever high grades they deserve, then a Messenger came afterwards, they would believe in and support him. Even though Allah has given the Prophets the knowledge and the prophethood, this fact should not make them refrain from following and supporting the Prophet who comes after them. This is why Allah, the Most High, Most Honored, said 4f£?J Oi ft 4And (remember) when Allah took the covenant of the Prophets, saying: "Take whatever I gave you from the Book and Hikmah.'y

meaning, if I give you the Book and the Hikmah, afterwards there will come to you a Messenger confirming what is with you; you must, then, believe in him and help him." Allah said, "Do you agree (to it) and will you take up Isri?"} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ar-Rabl‘, Qatadah and As-Suddi said that 7srf means, “My covenant.”* 1 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that, ^Isri} means, “The responsibility of My covenant that you took,”*2 * meaning, the ratified pledge that you gave Me. iTley said: ,r We agree." He said: "Then bear witness; and I am with you among the witnesses." then whoever turns away after this,} from fulfilling this pledge and covenant, ithey are the rebellious.} ‘Ali bin Abi Talib and his cousin ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas said, “Allah never sent a Prophet but after taking his pledge that if Muhammad jg were sent in his lifetime, he would believe in and support him.”*31 Allah commanded each Prophet to take a pledge from his nation that if Muhammad were sent in their time, they would believe in and support him. Tawus, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah said, “Allah took the pledge from the Prophets that they would believe in each other”, and this statement does not contradict what ‘Ali and Ibn ‘Abbas stated. Therefore, Muhammad is the Final Prophet jg until the Day of Resurrection. He is the greatest Imam, who if he existed in Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :373 ,374. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :273 131 At-Tabari 6:555.

any time period, deserves to be obeyed, rather than all other Prophets. This is why Muhammad jg led the Prophets in prayer during the night of Isra’ when they gathered in Bayt Al- Maqdis (Jerusalem). He is the intercessor on the Day of Gathering, when the Lord comes to judge between His servants. This is Al-Maqam Al- Mahmud (the praised station) [refer to 17:79) that only Muhammad deserves, a responsibility which the mighty Prophets and Messengers will decline to assume. However, Muhammad 2g will carry the task of intercession, may Allah’s peace and blessings be on him. g)g))i£ n V— «•js y u?i a ds- <w -- » “”4 J yy ' . gr* •'>'> - "z> <r.-f < * , f *Ui' /'-ft>> >•jjili l5 j ouie, 0;J'J), {ljj viU'S 4-d}j yjdl' 4 !>• ^L>y*~i J>' f-if&l it* ty Uj Jit l—i»L j» >jm j-^ri C5i H oi Jj 1 ty 4'V-'Vb -Oy »JS - --.A*? . '>-• >» <'>• •tf ,< ,<•»;! "r "< > . •> >r •>•<- Cl? j _y»J J-i jU t-j (^L.^1 jf. gj Cj*j —* {*> 4"fUzP\$ 483. Do they seek other than the religion of Allah, while to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned. 484. Say : "We believe in Allah and in what has been sent

down to us, and what was sent down to Ibrahim, Ismd'tl, Ishaq, Ya'qub and Al-Asbdt, and what was given to Musa, 'Isa and the Prophets from their Lord. We make no distinction between one another among them and to Him (Allah) we have submitted.") 485. And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhim, and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers.) The Only Valid Religion To Allah is Islam Allah rebukes those who prefer a religion other than the religion that He sent His Books and Messengers with, which is the worship of Allah Alone without partners, to Whom, 4submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth,) Willingly, or not. Allah said in other Ayat, 4^Jj

uj'jV'j 4 -w> Zif) 4And unto Allah (Alone) falls in prostration whoever is in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly.) [13:15], and, >J k JPB owif £m & * #& u !£ iHave they not observed things that Allah has created : (how) their shadows incline to the right and to the left, making prostration unto Allah, and they are lowly? And to Allah prostrate all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, of the moving creatures and the angels, and they are not proud. They fear their Lord above them, and they do what tlthey are commanded) [16:48-50). Therefore, the faithful believer submits to Allah in heart and body, while the disbeliever unwillingly submits to Him in body only, since he is under Allah's power, irresistible control and mighty kingship that cannot be repelled or resisted. Wakf reported that Mujahid said that the Ayah,

4'a^==, j 4 ^ T^ij iWhile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth , willingly or unwillingly}, is similar to the Ayah, iAnd verily, if you ask them : "Who created the heavens and the earth?" Surely, they will say: "Allah"}ll] [39 :38). He also reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about, > if'si'b i&S <4 i>* tAj} iwhile to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly.} "When He took the covenant from them." 121 iAnd to Him shall they all be returned} on the Day of Return, when He will reward or punish each person according to his or her deeds. Allah then said, its 3j Z'j% dft \$} iSay : "We believe in Allah and in what has been sent down to us} the Qur'an, iSSf iUSlj &\$ ~tj} iand what was sent down to Ibrahim, Ismai'l, Ishaq, Ya'qub} the scriptures and revelation, i±S%} iand the Asbdt,} the Asbat are the twelve tribes who originated from the twelve children of Israel (Ya'qub). t'j,} iand what was given to Musa, 'Isa} the Tawrah and the Injfl, 1,1 At-Jabari 6 :565 121 At-Tabari 6:565. Refer to 7:172-173.

oi iand the Prophetsfrom their Lord.} and this encompasses all of Allah's Prophets. 4-*^ -P^ o>i> y} iWe make no distinction between one another among them we believe in all of them, 4And to Him (Allah) we have submitted (in Islam)} Therefore, faithful Muslims believe in every Prophet whom Allah has sent and in every Book He revealed, and never disbelieve in any of them. Rather, they believe in what was revealed by Allah, and in every Prophet sent by Allah. Allah said next. 4a--2 S-i*i ii1* Vti (A-W cyj} 4And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted ofhim,} whoever seeks other than what Allah has legislated, it will not be accepted from him, 0? j £j} 4and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers.} As the Prophet jfe said in an authentic Hadith, «Sj i »Whoever commits an action that does not conform to our matter (religion) then it is rejected».ll) *—^r j»- o' 'j Uy «at y ' jwUiii i > y 'iifj 'Jj m,oj_^j (ii yj i'joJ' --ii* y av .jv«1»^ . OJA* oj' oJ» 'yJ-Jj OiJ'j Juu iyt Fath Al-Bari 5 :355

486. How shall Allah guide a people who disbelieved after their beliefand after they bore witness that the Messenger is true and after clear proofs came to them? And Allah guides not the people zoho are wrongdoers 487. They are those whose recompense is that on them (rests) tlte curse ofAllah, of the angels and of all mankind. 488. They will abide therein. Neither will their torment be lightened nor will it be delayed or postponed.) 489. Except for those who repent after that and do righteous deeds. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Allah Does Not Guide People Who Disbelieve After they Believed, Unless They Repent Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "A man from the Ansar embraced Islam, but later reverted and joined the polytheists. He later on became sorry and sent his people to, 'Ask the Messenger of Allah for me, if I can repent.' Then, 4(*r-*^V ill 4Hmo shall Allah

guide a people who disbelieved after their belief) until, js*- *>>' 4 Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) was revealed and his people sent word to him and he re- embraced Islam. ",11 This is the wording recorded by An-Nasa'i, Al-Hakim and Ibn Hibban . 121 Al-Hakim said, "Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it." Allah's statement, 4Menu shall Allah guide a people who disbelieved after their belief and after they bore witness that the Messenger is true and after clear proofs came to them? m At-Tabari 6 :572 121 An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :31 1 , Al Hakim 4 :366 , Ibn Hibban 6 :323

means, the proofs and evidences were established, testifying to the truth of what the Messenger was sent with. The truth was thus explained to them, but they reverted to the darkness of polytheism. Therefore, how can such people deserve guidance after they willingly leapt into utter blindness? This is why Allah said, i&M y%} iAnd Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.} He then said, iThey are those whose recompense is that on them (rests) the curse of Allah, of the angels and of all mankind.} Allah curses them and His creation also curses them. iTthey will abide therein in the curse, iNeither will their torment be lightened nor loill it be delayed or postponed.} for, the torment will not be lessened, not even for an hour. After that, Allah said, t < T.ik ill 1.h -S' iExcept for those who repent after that and do righteous deeds. Verily, Alldlt is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This Ayah indicates Allah's kindness, graciousness, compassion, mercy and favor on His creatures when they repent to Him, for He forgives them in this case. £ >¥& & j 2 & k\$ & ^ *\$2\$ M& k 490. Verily, those who disbelieved after their belief and then went on increasing in their disbelief never will their repentance be accepted. And they are those who are astray.}

207 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3 491. Verily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them if they offered it as a ransom . For them is a painful torment and they will have no helpers.} Neither Repentance of the Disbeliever Upon Death, Nor His Ransoming Himself on the Day of Resurrection Shall be Accepted Allah threatens and warns those who revert to disbelief after they believed and who thereafter insist on disbelief until death. He states that in this case, no repentance shall be accepted from them upon their death. Similarly, Allah said, til O&dli Sj c LZ <<Ub, c^,} 4 And of no effect is the repentance of those who continue to do evil deeds until death faces one of them > (4:18). This is why Allah said. 4never will their repentance be accepted. And they are those who went astray.} to those who abandon the path of truth for the path of wickedness. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that some people embraced Islam, reverted to disbelief, became Muslims again, then reverted from Islam. They sent their people inquiring about this matter and they asked the Messenger of Allah jg. On that, this Ayah was revealed, 4#£ & S j&M W Sj k> 4 Verily, those who disbelieved after their belief and then went on increasing in their disbelief never will their repentance be accepted}. The chain of narration is satisfactory. Thereafter, Allah said. JS C3S Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 2:258.

208 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr , & s* •+ 4^ 4 Verily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (ivhole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them even if they offered it as a ransom.} Those who die while disbelievers, shall have no good deed ever accepted from them, even if they spent the earth's fill of gold in what was perceived to be an act of obedience. The Prophet was asked about 'Abdullah bin Jud'an, who used to be generous to guests, helpful to the indebted and who gave food (to the poor); will all that benefit him? The Prophet jg said, fy- u!! •:} 'J

y*""ll J* Ujj ^Lsj ^_5 AjJ «No, for not even one day during his life did he pronounce, 'O my Lord! Forgive my sins on the Day of Judgment. Similarly, if the disbeliever gave the earth's full of gold as ransom, it will not be accepted from him. Allah said, yj yj> .nor shall compensation be accepted from him, nor shall intercession be ofuse to him>[2:123), and .0n which there will be neither mutual bargaining nor befriending.} (14:31], and, it .4, \jj3Sj LLL JILj &J; 4 u & ') sii if} 4IP • ^ 1* j .**) 1 kj'je 4tor/71/, those who disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again therewith to ransom themselves thereby from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it would never be accepted of them, and theirs would be a painful tonnent} [5:36]. This is why Allah said here, Si Sg uM k pi Muslim 1 :196.

209Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-3) iVerily, those who disbelieved, and died while they were disbelievers, the (whole) earth full of gold will not be accepted from anyone of them if they offered it as a ransom. The implication of this Ayah is that the disbeliever shall never avoid the torment of Allah, even if he spent the earth's fill of gold, or if he ransoms himself with the earth's fill of gold, - all of its mountains, hills, sand, dust, valleys, forests, land and sea. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah gg said, ppj l>' N| Vj jt-1 <y*jjp : Jy? '•pr* '-?> c?' jXP. (Jyii iJs.Q 'j *ji y-* Ji <Jl 'jJ. 1>'j i: :Jfid Ps y\ U jfid j&> yi ip 40 ifi -dyd "4r * ,dii . ji ip ui 'jj ui ,y , iit P&L ji aA man from among the people of Paradise will be brought and Allah will ask him, "O son of Adam! How did you find your dwelling?" He will say, "O Lord, it is the best dwelling." Allah will say, "Ask and wish." The man will say, "I only ask and wish that You send me back to the world so tlmt I am killed ten times in Your cause," because of the honor of martyrdom he would experience. A man from among the people of the Fire will be brought, and Allah will say to him, "O son of Adam! How do you find your dwelling?" He will say, "It is the worst dwelling, O Lord." Allah will ask him, "Would you ransom yourself from Me with the earth's fill of gold?" He will say, "Yes, O Lord." Allah will say, "You have lied. I asked you to do wluit is less and easier than that, but you did not do it," and he will be sent back to the Fire. This is why Allah said, 4^" <j? (A1& Xt) 111 Ahmad 3:207.

iFor them is a painful torment and they will have no helpers.} for they shall not have anyone who will save them from the torment of Allah or rescue them from His painful punishment. & Ji Oy£ '4 •%& 492. By no means shall you attain Al-Birr, un- less you spend of that which you love; and whatever of good you spend, Alldh knows it well.} Al-Birr is Spending from the Best of One's Wealth In his Tafsir, Wak! ' reported, that 'Amr bin Maymun said that msi&z it sgjp £-j?j i S,, . ' < SX S>' £r\ f OIjW4J Cg^Ua)ji£Jlfej DjL*a - ""ffJ i'u'l' \S 'v'A'. ' 'sHf?' ob>4io-acr*j>;A^^ 0SEZE\$ { > I i Sfl'Sif*' S' ,.' vXWtAi'.f- 4% ijbr <By no means shall you attain Al-Birr} is in reference to attaining Paradise.¹¹ ' Imam Ahmad reported that Anas bin Malik said, "Abu Talhah had more property than any other among the Ansar in Al-Madlnah, and the most beloved of his property to him was Bayruha' garden, which was in front of the (Messenger's) Masjid. Sometimes, Allah's Messenger jg used to go to the garden and drink its fresh water." Anas added, "When these verses were revealed, m At-Tabari : 6:587.

% \SZ iBy tio means shall you attain Al-Birr unless You spend of that which you love,} Abu Talhah said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Allah says, 4% e* ft*£2m ^By no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of that which you love; } No doubt, Bayruha' garden is the most beloved of all my property to me. So I want to give it in charity in Allah's cause, and I expect its reward and compensation from

Allah. O Allah's Messenger! Spend it where Allah makes you think is feasible.' On that, Allah's Messenger jg said, <• „, \$ (f } , y^ ^ ^ ^ ^ ^ ^ x y ^ ^ Jij 4 4jt* tlb 4 ilb 4 -'A:. «Well-done! It is profitable property, it is profitable property. I have heard what you have said, and I think it would be proper if you gave it to your kith and kin .» Abu Talhah said, 1 will do so, O Allah's Messenger.' Then Abu Talhah distributed that garden among his relatives and cousins." This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahths. They also recorded that 'Umar said, "O Messenger of Allah! I never gained possession of a piece of property more precious to me than my share in Khaybar. Therefore, what do you command me to do with it?" The Prophet jfe said, ^Retain the land to give its fruits in Allah's cause. »[31 Ahmad 3 : 141 Fath Al-Bari 8 :71 and Muslim 2 :663 Its meaning is with Muslim 3:1256 and An-Nasal 6:232, who mentioned it. This is Ibn Majah's narration.

& 4^ Jt J6 J'tD-'l t* "2?l 3i^r\ Jf yy _ // *y y/ - y , • jLy -y ii'y -y < t(y ,i *1 y y ^ /</> Jc cfyj' .^T, 'j i_p\j Ji -O^i Jyj Uj U~J» «#t li-O ji ^ ' Ojiltlilt j^i Jijjili viO'i Jji J,jEji ar i.& 493. All food was lawful to the Children of Israel, except what Isra'il made unlawful for himself before the Tawrdh was revealed. Say: "Bring here the Tawrdh and recite it, if you are truthful/> 494. Then after that, whosoever shall invent a lie against Allah, then it is these that are the wrongdoers. ^ 495. Say:"Allah has spoken the truth; follow > the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (monotheist) , and he was not of the Mushrikin (idolaters) The Questions that the Jews Asked Our Prophet jg Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "A group of Jews came to Allah's Prophet jg and said, Talk to us about some things we will ask you and which only a Prophet would know.' He said, 'Ask me about whatever you wish. However, give your pledge to Allah, similar to the pledge that Ya'qub took from his children, that if I tell you something and you recognize its truth, you will follow me in Islam.' They said, 'Agreed.' The Prophet jll said, 'Ask me about whatever you wish.' They said, Tell us about four matters: 1. What kinds of food did Isra'fl prohibit for himself? 2. What about the sexual discharge of the woman and the man, and what role does each play in producing male or female offspring? 3. Tell us about the condition of the unlettered Prophet during sleep, 4. And who is his Wali (supporter) among the angels?' The Prophet took their covenant that they will follow him if he answers these questions, and they agreed. He said, 'I ask you by He Who sent down the Tawrah to Musa, do you not know that Isra'il once became very ill? When his illness was prolonged, he vowed to Allah that if He cures His illness, he would prohibit the best types of drink and food for himself.

Was not the best food to him camel meat and the best drink camel milk?' They said, "Yes, by Allah.' The Messenger sg said, 'O Allah, be Witness against them.' The Prophet jg then said, 'I ask you by Allah, other than Whom there is no deity (worthy of worship), Who sent down the Tawrah to Musa, do you not know that man's discharge is thick and white and woman's is yellow and thin? If any of these fluids becomes dominant, the offspring will take its sex and resemblance by Allah's leave. Hence, if the man's is more than the woman's, the child will be male, by Allah's leave. If the woman's discharge is more than the man's, then the child will be female, by Allah's leave.' They said, 'Yes.' He said, 'O Allah, be Witness against them.' He then said, "I ask you by He Who sent down the Tawrah to Musa, do you not know that the eyes of this unlettered Prophet sleep, but his heart does not sleep?' They said, *¥68, by Allah!' He said, 'O Allah, be Witness.' They said, Tell us now about your Wali among the angels, for this is when we either follow or shun you.' He said, "My Wali (who brings down the revelation from Allah) is Jibril, and Allah never sent a Prophet, but Jibril is his Wali.' They said, We

then shun you. Had you a Wali other than Jibril, we would have followed you.' On that, Allah, the Exalted revealed, ASay: "Whoever is an enemy to fibril..." } [2:97]." 111 Allah's statement, Jji! J Ji} ibefore the Tawrah ivas revealed} [3:93], means, Israel forbade that for himself before the Tawrah was revealed. There are two objectives behind revealing this segment of the Ayah. First, he forbade himself the most delightful things for Allah's sake. This practice was allowed during his period of Law, and is, thus, suitable that it is mentioned after Allah's statement, X' 4 A0*4 j} ABy no means shall you attain Al-Birr, unless you spend of Ahmad 1 :287.

that which you love (3:92). What we are allowed in our Law is to spend in Allah's obedience from what we like and covet [but not to prohibit what Allah has allowed]. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd gives his wealth, in spite of lovefor it,) [2:177], and; 4'V- J* Jj^j) iAnd they givefood, in spite of their lovefor it,) [76:8]. The second reason is that after Allah refuted the false Christian beliefs and allegations about Isa and his mother. Allah started refuting the Jews here, may Allah curse them, by stating that the abrogation of the Law, that they denied occurs, already occurred in their Law. For instance, Allah has stated in their Book, the Tawrah, that when Nuh departed from the ark, Allah allowed him to eat the meat of all types of animals. Afterwards, Israll forbade the meat and milk of camels for himself, and his children imitated this practice after him. The Tawrah later on prohibited this type of food, and added several more types of prohibitions. Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons, and this practice was later forbidden. The Law of Ibrahim allowed the man to take female servants as companions along with his wife, as Ibrahim did when he took Hajar, while he was married to Sarah. Later on, the Tawrah prohibited this practice. It was previously allowed to take two sisters as wives at the same time, as Ya'qub married two sisters at the same time. Later on, this practice was prohibited in the Tawrah. All these examples are in the Tawrah and constitute a Naskh (abrogation) of the Law. Therefore, let the Jews consider what Allah legislated for Isa and if such legislation falls under the category of abrogation or not. Why do they not then follow Isa in this regard? Rather, the Jews defied and rebelled against Isa and against the correct religion that Allah sent Muhammad SS with. This is why Allah said,

iAll food was lawful to the Children of Israel, except what Isrd'tl made unlawful for himself before the Tawrdh was revealed} [3:93] meaning, before the Tawrah was revealed, all types of foods were allowed, except what Isratl prohibited for himself. Allah then said, Cl }Say: "Bring here the Tawrdh and recite it, if you are truthful."}, for the Tawrah affirms what we are stating here. Allah said next, iThen after that, whosoever shall invent a lie against Allah, then these it is that are the wrongdoers.} [3:94], in reference to those who lie about Allah and claim that He made the Sabbath and the Tawrah eternal. They are those who claim that Allah did not send another Prophet calling to Allah with the proofs and evidences, although evidence indicates that abrogation, as we have described, occurred before in the Tawrah, ithen these it is that are the wrongdoers.} Allah then said, t \$} iSay, "Allah has spoken the truth;" } [3:95] meaning, O Muhammad, say that Allah has said the truth in what He conveyed and legislated in the Qur'an, ^follow the religion ofIbrahim the Hanif, and he was not of the idolators."} [3:95]. Therefore, follow the religion of Ibrahim that Allah legislated in the Qur'an. Indeed, this is the truth, there is no doubt in it, and the perfect way, and no Prophet has brought a more complete, clear, plain and perfect way than he did. Allah said in other Ayat,

S- £ Cj u O. 4* J?>> J! 4; ^ j*^ 4>:*C^ 4Say ; "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, the Hanif, and he was not of the idolaters."} [6:161] and, * Sf Cj %§ o\ te\ p} iThen, We have sent the revelation to you (saying): ",Follow the religion of Ibrahim, the Hanif, and he was not of the idolaters .} 116:123]. fLU C Kt if 1.,caJijJ t jW* 'y~±'. 0]^ 'Ly.^ cJj' gp pjilil' Jefki tyi*^ fa-* jLfJil cfi is? 496. Verily, the first House (of worship) appointed for mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin (mankind and Jinn). 497. In it are manifest signs (for example), the Maqam (station) of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security. And Hajj to the House is a duty that mankind owes to Allah, for those who are able to undertake the journey ; and whoever disbelieves, then Allah stands not in need of any of the 'Alamin.} The Ka'bah is the First House of Worship Allah said, £fi y* Jj' h\} iVerily, the first House appointed for mankind} for all people, for their acts of worship and religious rituals. They go around the House (in Tawaf, pray in its vicinity and remain in its area in 1'tikaf. iwas that at Bakkah,} meaning, the Ka'bah that was built by Ibrahim Al-Khalil, whose religion the Jews and Christians claim

they follow. However, they do not perform Hajj to the house that Ibrahim built by Allah's command, and to which he invited the people to perform Hajj. Allah said next, 4full of blessing), sanctified, iand a guidance for Al-'Alamin.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr said; "I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Which Masjid was the first to be built on the surface of the earth?' He said, 'Al-Masjid Al-Haram (in Makkah).' I said, Which was built next?' He replied 'Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa (in Jerusalem).' I said, What was the period of time between building the two?' He said, 'Forty years.' He added, ^Wherever (you may be, and) the prayer becomes due, perform the prayer there, for the whole earth was made a Masjid .n"* 11 Al-Bukhari and Muslim*21 also collected this Hadith. The Names of Makkah, Such As 'Bakkah' Allah said, i%4 j> iwas that at Bakkah}, where Bakkah is one of the names of Makkah. Bakkah means, 'it brings Buka' (crying, weeping) to the tyrants and arrogant, meaning they cry and become humble in its vicinity. It was also said that Makkah was called Bakkah because people do Buka next to it, meaning they gather around it. There are many names for Makkah, such as Bakkah, Al-Bayt Al-'Atiq (the Ancient House), Al-Bayt Al-Haram (the Sacred House), Al-Balad Al-Amin (the City of Safety) and Al-Ma'mun (Security). Makkah's names include Umm Rahm (Mother of Mercy), Umm Al-Qura (Mother of the Towns), Salah, (as well as others]. m Ahmad 5:150. *21 Fath Al-Bari 6 :469 . Muslim 1 :370

218 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir The Station of Ibrahim Allah's statement, c4' 4In it are manifest signs} [3:97], means, clear signs that Ibrahim built the Ka'bah and that Allah has honored and blessed it. Allah then said, A P& i the Maqam (station) of Ibrahim} When the building [the Ka'bah] was raised, Ibrahim stood on; the Maqam so that he could raise the walls higher, while his son Ismail was handing the stones to him. We should mention that the Maqam used to be situated right next to the House. Later, and during his reign, 'Umar bin Al-Khattab moved the Maqam farther to the east, so that those who go around the House in Tawaf are able to perform it easily, without disturbing those who pray next to the Maqam after finishing their Tawaf. Allah commanded us to pray next to the Maqam; iAnd take you (people) the Maqam (station) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer} [2:125]. We mentioned the Hadiths about this subject before, and still the thanks are due to Allah. Al-'Awfi said that, Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, \+sfyl cy* lj^ iln it are manifest signs, the Maqam of Ibrahim;} "Such as the Maqam and Al-Mash'ar [Al-Ifar&m]." 111 Mujahid said, "The impression of Ibrahim's feet remains on the Maqam as a

clear sign.” 121 It was reported that Umar bin ‘Abdul-‘Aziz, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others said similarly. ,3 At-Tabari 7 :26. Af-Tabari 7 :27 131 Ibn AbiHatim 2:412 ,413.

219Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-4) Al-Haram the Sacred Area, is a Safe Area Allah said, JU-J Jb) ^whosoever enters it, he attains security,) [3:97] meaning, the Haram of Makkah is a safe refuge for those in a state of fear. There in its vicinity, they will be safe, just as was the case during the time of JahUiyyah. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “(During the time of Jahiliyyah) a man would commit murder, then wear a piece of wool around his neck and enter the Haram. And even when the son of the murdered person would meet him, he would not make a move against him, until he left the sanctuary.” Allah said, it j-ti J&Zj o: ^ QZ. 0 i£ ft) iHavc they not seen that We have made (Makkah) a secure sanctuary, while men are being snatched away from all around them?) [29:67], and, £> 0; > < «»0 Ojj' C>j iSo let them worship (Allah) the Lord of this House (the Ka'bah). (He) Who has fed them against hunger, and lias made them safe from fear) [106:3-4]. It is not allowed for anyone to hunt in the Haram or to drive game out of its den to be hunted, or cut the trees in its vicinity, or pick its grass, as the Hadlths of the Prophet jg and the statements of the Companions testify. The Two Sahihs recorded (this being the wording of Muslim) that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “On the day of the conquest of Makkah, the Messenger of Allah sg said, “There is no more Hijrah (migration to Makkah), only jihad and good intention. If you were mobilized, then march forth . He also said on the day of the conquest of Makkah, Jr! Sf[J J>«j jJj ,J~ (0 {y.

>> ;£^ la"^- *Vj i 111'.P j^o N 1 Lfrlkl l>i:l> oBeware! Allah made this town (Makkah) a sanctuary when He created the heavens and earth, and it is sacred by Allah's decree until the Day of Resurrection. Fighting in Makkah was not permitted for anyone before me, and it was made legal for me for only a few hours or so on that day. No doubt it is at this moment a sanctuary by Allah's decree until the Day of Resurrection. It is not allowed to uproot its thorny shrubs, hunt its game, pick up its lost objects, except by announcing it, or to uproot its trees. Al-‘Abbas said, ‘Except the lemon grass, O Allah’s Messenger, as they use it in their houses and graves.’ The Prophet jfe; said: «Except lemongrass The Two Sahihs also recorded that Abu Shurayh Al-‘Adawi said that he said to ‘Amr bin Said while he was sending the troops to Makkah (to fight ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr), “O Commander! Allow me to tell you what Allah’s Messenger said on the day following the conquest of Makkah. My ears heard it and my heart memorized it thoroughly, and I saw the Prophet jg with my own eyes when he, after glorifying and praising Allah, said, j>fl\ 3il ; {jiji isfi'i jfon pj ^ <j!s *U)I <Jy Jlii j JL>-i l 0 "ij t 1*0 tgj i-ii Irt jif idp jiU pj Oil 3)1 jj :«J \jijH . ** jl&LiJI *S/1 l L o) p jSj tjtjJ «Allah, not the people, made Makkah a sanctuary. Therefore, anybody who has belief in Allah and the Last Day, slwuld neither shed blood in it nor cut down its trees. If anybody argues that fighting in it is permissible on the basis that Allah's Messenger fought in Makkah, say to him, 'Allah allowed His m Fath Al-Bari4 :56, Muslim 2 :986.

222Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) Messenger and did not allow you.' Allah allowed me only for a few hours on that day (of the conquest), and today its sanctity is as valid as it was before. So, those who are present, should inform those who are absent of this facto'." Abu Shurayh was asked, “What did 'Amr reply?” He said that ‘Amr said, “O Abu Shurayh! I know better than you in this respect; Makkah does not give protection to a sinner, a murderer or a thief.” Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, «None of you is allowed to carry a weapon in Makkah .» Muslim12 ' recorded this Hadith. ‘Abdullah bin ‘Adi bin Al-Hamra’ Az-Zuhri said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say

while standing at Al-Hazwarah in the marketplace of Makkah, U vtlif w->-j>-\ Ijill aBy Allah! You are the best of Allah's land and the most beloved land to Allah. Had it not been for the fact that I was driven out of you, I would not have left you³ ' Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith and this is his wording. At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah⁴ ' also collected it. At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahth." The Necessity of Performing Hajj Allah said, >. £ ,4b^ 4And Hajj to the House is a duty that mankind owes to Allah, for those who are able to undertake the journey} [3:97]. Muslim 2:987. ' Muslim 2 :989 131 Ahmad 4:305. •4| Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10 :426 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 2 :479 , Ibn Majah

This Ayah established the obligation of performing Hajj. There are many Hadiths that mention it as one of the pillars and fundamentals of Islam, and this is agreed upon by the Muslims. According to texts and the consensus of the scholars, it is only obligatory for the adult Muslim to perform it once during his lifetime. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jfcr once gave a speech in which he said, "O people! Hajj has been enjoined on you, therefore, perform Hajj . A man asked, "Is it every year, O Allah's Messenger?" The Prophet remained silent until the man repeated the question three times and he then said, dj jUi : cii -fo Had I said yes, it would have become an obligation and you would not have been able to fulfill it.* He said next, dil* ILli y U jc- bjj U Ka lyd jjpw lilj Leave me as I leave you, those before you were destroyed because of their many questions and disputing with their Prophets. If I command you with something, perform it as much as you can. If I forbid something for you, then refrain from ilV Muslim recorded similarly. Meaning of 'Afford* in the Ayah There are severed categories of "the ability to under take the journey". There is the physical ability of the person himself and the ability that is related to other things as mentioned in the books of jurisprudence. Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi recorded that Ibn Tlmar said, "A man stood up and asked the Messenger of Allah sg, 'O Messenger of Allah! Who is the pilgrim?' He said, 'He who has untidy hair and clothes.' Another man asked, 'Which Hajj is better, O Messenger of Allah?' He said, The noisy Ahmad 2 :508 , Muslim 2:975.

(with supplication to Allah) and bloody (with sacrifice).' Another man asked, "What is the ability to undertake the journey, O Messenger of Allah?" He said, 'Having provision and a means of transportation.'" 111 This is the narration that Ibn Majah collected. 121 Al-Hakim narrated that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah was asked about Allah's statement, ifor those who are able to undertake the journey (3:97] "What does 'able to undertake the journey' mean?" The Prophet sg answered, "Having sufficient provision and a means of transportation." Al-Hakim stated that this Hadith's chain of narration is authentic, following the guidelines of Muslim in his Sahih, but the Two Sahihs did not collect it. 3 ^ Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, £Jl Sij\ s' *Whoever intends to perforin Hajj, let him rush to perform if."*41 Abu Dawud also collected this Hadith , The One who Denies the Necessity of Hajj Becomes a Disbeliever Allah said, iU £%# *4X& i...and whoever disbelieves, then Allah stands not in need of any of the 'Alamin [3:97]. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and several others commented on this Ayah, "Whoever denies the necessity of Hajj becomes disbeliever, and Allah is far Richer than to need him." Al-Hafiz "" Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :348 Ibn Majah 2 :96. 131 Al-Hakim 1 :442 . The Hadiths about provision and means that are mentioned here are all weak narrations. Al-Bayhaqi graded the Hadith Hasan, but Al-Albani and Muqbil bin Hadi graded it weak. See Al-Irwa' no . 988 141 Ahmad 1 :225. Abu Dawud 2 :350

Abu Bakr Al-Ismailli recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "Whoever can afford Hajj but did not perform it, there is no difference in his case if he dies while Jew or Christian." This has an authentic chain of narration leading to Umar. jits j» v&L p. jits t*j 04* O4 ^ Jt^ J5 Ojliu P it 498. Say: "O People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Why do you reject the Aydt of Allah, while Allah is Wihwss to what you do?"} 499. Say: "O People of the Scripture (Jeivs and Christians)! Why do you stop those who have believed, from the path of Allah, seeking to make it seem crooked, while you (yourselves) are witnesses? And Allah is not unaware of what you do."} Chastising the People of the Book for Their Disbelief and Blocking the Path of Allah In this Ayah Allah criticizes the disbelieving People of the Book for refusing the truth, rejecting Allah's Aydt and hindering those who seek to believe from His path, although they know that what the Messenger jg was sent with is the truth from Allah. They learned this from the previous Prophets and honorable Messengers, may Allah's peace and blessings be on them all. They all brought the glad tidings and the good news of the coming of the unlettered, Arab, Hashimi Prophet from Makkah, the master of the Children of Adam, the Final Prophet and the Messenger of the Lord of heavens and earth. Allah has warned the People of the Book against this behavior, stating that He is Witness over what they do, indicating their defiance of the knowledge conveyed to them by the Prophets. They rejected, denied and refused the very Messenger whom they were ordered to convey the glad tidings about his coming. Allah states that He is never unaware of what they do, and He will hold them responsible for their actions, nr Al-Hilyah 9 :252

pEs=». AJ AUivl^jU 4UI> m lC^J ^ f*-4/^}d' tpjl\yj\c © SjXi ^ *^> V |y>^ ^77ie Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail> [26:88). LAc-i*3 o), 0j\$ 'j3^ jyI' ,jj '-:S/ -M m frl p& & pr3&& JSj l. 4J^*j j\$ yL£\)fi/+ Ji <£•£•* -UJ 4it ^100. O you io/fo believe! If you obey a group of those who were given the Scripture (Jexvs and Christians), they would (indeed) render you disbelievers after you have believed!} iLOL. And how would you disbelieve, while unto you are recited the verses of Allah, and among you is His Messenger? And whoever depends upon Allah, then he is indeed guided to the right path.} jLJIj*gjA>-^jii&f-^3 \&Sfk'4P t i'»>> -i '•** fi-'tV /CV,ir j&j ~ fjjpCyydo^jSLo i_jIJBjI i^s_jjj flip Warning Muslims Against Imitating People of the Scriptures Allah warns His believing servants against obeying the People of the Book, who envy the believers for the favor that Allah gave them by sending His Messenger jg. Similarly, Allah said, t yjiT jJ« j &OK£ \$ 4""^ 3j^ 4-h-s^ ^Many o/ ffe Peop/e of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you

have believed, out of their mvn envy} [2:109]. In this Ayah [3:100], Allah said, M f&J. lA*' 6.' Sj 4If you obey a group of those who were given the Scripture (Jeivs and Christians) , they would (indeed) render you disbelievers after you have believed!}, then said, 4And how would you disbelieve, while unto you are recited the verses of Allah, and among you is His Messenger?}, meaning, disbelief is far from touching you, since the Ayat of Allah are being sent down on His Messenger 5g day and night, and he recites and conveys them to you. Similarly, Allah said, r 4 iii jg; % -u * &w 4And what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! While the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord; and He has indeed taken your covenant, if you are real believers} [57:8]. A Hadith states that one day, the Prophet said to his Companions, V Czs'jt : JI» .a£VJI :iyu «?UU4 ^>1)1 4*1" y Jfi ^ j 1 'jA-j ^Ul :l^3U C'ij JjL}; i JCSf :JU ,j>ci :l^li * ^4-j Hi o VULqjI i"Who among the faithful believers do you consider has the most amazing faith?" They said, "The angels." He said, "Why would they not believe, since

they are with their Lord?" They mentioned the Prophets, and the Prophet ﷺ said, "Why would they not believe while the revelation is sent down to them?" They said, "Then, we are." He said, "Why would not you believe when I am among you?" They asked, "Who has the most amazing faith?" The Prophet said, "A people who will

227 Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-4) come after you and who will find only books that they will believe in." Allah said next, (sA Al -i>C 4 And whoever depends upon Allah, then he is indeed guided to the right path [3:101] for trusting and relying on Allah are the basis of achieving the right guidance and staying away from the path of wickedness. They also represent the tool to acquiring guidance and truth and achieving the righteous aims. it?. ij fA Jilt cAt iyju "jj ii_JL .#& '<& 'it *£^ ^ viSf s*)% £ pi ^ i.'ft.S/xj •\$& 4102. O you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah as is His due, and die not except as (true) Muslims .} 4103. And hold fast, all of you together, to the Rope of Allah, and be not divided among yourselves, and remember Allah's favor on you, for you were enemies of one another but He joined your hearts together, so that, by His grace, you became brethren, and you were on the brink of a pit of Fire, and He saved you from it. Thus Allah makes His Ayat clear to you, that you may be guided.) Meaning of *Taqwa of Allah' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud commented on the Ayah, i.iti> it iHave Taqwd of Allah as is His due,} "That He is obeyed and not defied, remembered and not forgotten and appreciated and not unappreciated." 121 This has [1 ' At-Tabarani 4:22,23. * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :446

an authentic chain of narration to 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud. Al- Hakim collected this Hadith in his Mustadrak, from Ibn Mas'ud, who related it to the Prophet ﷺ. Al-Hakim said, "It is authentic according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs [A1- Bukhari and Muslim], and they did not record it." This is what he said, but it appears that it is only a statement of 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud, and Allah knows best. It was also reported that Anas said, "The servant will not have Taqwa of Allah as is His due until he keeps his tongue idle." 121 Allah's statement, iand die not except as (true) Muslims} [3:102], means, preserve your Islam while you are well and safe, so that you die as a Muslim. The Most Generous Allah has made it His decision that whatever state one lives in, that is what he dies upon and is resurrected upon. We seek refuge from dying on other than Islam. Imam Ahmad recorded that Mujahid said, "The people were circling around the Sacred House when Ibn 'Abbas was sitting, holding a bent-handled walking stick. Ibn 'Abbas said, The Messenger of Allah [recited], -ft vj iHavc Taqwa of Allah as is His due, die not except as (true) Muslims .} [3: 102], (then he said;) ck Ik (/fa J*. «*fJ'fa V] fUt S >3 «Verily, if a drop of Zaqqum (a tree in Hell) falls, it will spoil life for the people of earth. What about those whose food is only from Zaqqum?»" ,3' This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i, Ibn Majah, Ibn Hibban in his Sahih and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih" [41 while Al-Hakim said; "It meets the 111 Al-Hakim 2:294. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :448. 131 Ahmad 1 :300. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:307, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6:313, Ibn Majah 2:1446, Ibn Hibban 9 :278, Al-Hakim 2:294.

229 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) conditions of the Two Sahih and they did not record it." Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said that three nights before the Messenger of Allah died he heard him saying; «No»e of you should die except while having sincere trust in Allah, the Exalted and Most Honorable. n * Muslim also recorded it.'21 The Two Sahih record that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of

Allah said, "I am as My servant thinks of Me." The Necessity of Holding to the Path of Allah and the Community of the Believers Allah said next, "And hold fast, all of you together, to the Rope of Allah, and be not divided among yourselves." It was said that, "the Rope of Allah" refers to Allah's covenant, just as Allah said in the following Ayah, "And if indignity is put over them wherever they may be, except when under a covenant (of protection) from Allah, and from men;" [3:112], in reference to pledges and peace treaties. Allah's statement "and be not divided among yourselves", orders sticking to the 111 Ahmad 3:315. 121 Muslim 4:2205. 131 Fath Al-Bari 13:395. Muslim 4:2061

community of the believers and forbids division. There are several Hadiths that require adhering to the Jamd'ah (congregation of believers) and prohibit division. Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah Sg said, "ji i y op AAJ I o*j j {jA \ ilj jl j J 4J)1 I jl j l Uli Aj j t (JlylJl o fc <Jlij Ja>Jjj . ^5 It pleases Allah for you to acquire three qualities and displeases Him that you acquire three characteristics. It pleases Him that you worship Him Alone and not associate anything or anyone with Him in worship, that you hold on to the Rope of Allah altogether and do not divide, and that you advise whoever Allah appoints as your Leader. The three that displease Him are that you say, 'It was said,' and, 'So-and-so said,' asking many unnecessary questions and wasting money, n' Allah said, ifei. pCJX \$\$ £M ifoJ \$ cli \% \ i and remember Allah's favor on you, for you were enemies one to another but He joined your hearts together, so that, by His grace, you became brethren [3:103]. This was revealed about the Aws and Khazraj. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the Aws and Khazraj were at war and had great hatred, enmity and ill feelings towards each other, causing long conflicts and battles to occur between them. When Allah brought Islam, those among them who embraced it became brothers who loved each other by Allah's grace, having good ties for Allah's sake and helping each other in righteousness and piety. Allah said, U i H.Tr U I *!J jl |^li '-^1) .V . y-1ly .ij-A-. ^-0 j*^ kJj" 6^=aJj <Uf>. oil"1 m Muslim 3:1340.

iHc it is Who has supported you with His Help and with the be- lievers. And He has united their hearts. If you had spent all that is in the earth, you could not have united their hearts, but Allah has united them [8:62,63], until the end of the Ayah. Before Islam, their disbelief had them standing at the edge of a pit of the Fire, but Allah saved them from it and delivered them to faith. The Messenger of Allah sg reminded the Ansar (from both Aws and Khazraj] of this bounty when he was dividing the war booty of Hunayn. During that time, some Ansar did not like the way the booty was divided, since they did not get what the others did, although that was what Allah directed His Prophet jg to do. The Messenger of Allah gave them a speech, in which he said, m&m n saw Si' J J cfs*fifths .s\ i // •/ > - 'i' - ' >7" s_tAl.'iajSwJ i j^oj ajj'c/t J*Vi • -- fin / \>z" 't ' *iZ*'t*- j\jo «-Ljj a ' j 0_) ^ ^ 1 'J / >" *<* ' "> • v iJtjuulij^ <4 \$ ^ • •* - iiii 'fZsj Jii pi juJ^i Jjj. u» iui (liili-U 3u>^ "O Ansar! Did I 7wt find you misguided and Allah directed you to guidance because of me? Were you not divided beforehand and Allah united you around me? Were you not poor and Allah enriched you because of me? Whenever the Prophet jg asked them a question, they would answer, "Indeed, Allah and His Messenger have granted us

232 Tafstr ton Kathir bounty." 1,1 (** OyC*J jyjfcj j}& Oji-IC iil JSJj^ ^ litjjlj iilji ^:u C ^4 iir; *>•£»'.> urjif '>J2 •Vf (*+*>?•* Citi ?ji.j "ji-j Ja~£ fjj , i-Li- v'j <ul av*-j Jy k^a-l ^j5' U\> >Voj>So

J^T Uj ^IjuN lyjji C^el t4 Aj .>tjrvJlEl5 -k/> ii' v3^V Ujii *S>1 ££ i '+.Sy'H £j & JiJj0 4 Cj *\$£\$ 4104. Let there arise out of you a group of people inviting to all that is good (Islam), enjoining Al-Ma'ruf (all that Islam orders) and forbidding Al-Munkar (all that Islam has forbidden). And it is they who are the successful. > 4105. And be not as those who divided and differed among themselves after the clear proofs had come to them. It is they for whom there is an awful torment. \$ 4106. On the Day (i.e. the Day of Resurrection) when some faces will become white and some faces will become black; as for those whose faces will become black (to them will be said): "Did you reject faith after accepting it? Then taste the torment (in Hell) for rejecting faith." 4107. And for those whose faces will become white, they will be in Allah's mercy (Paradise), therein they shall dwell forever. 4108. These are the Ayat of Allah. We recite them to you in truth, and Allah wills no injustice to the 'Alamin.) 4109. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And all matters go back (for decision) to Allah. The Command to Establish the Invitation to Allah Allah said, 4^ 4 Let there arise out of you a group of people^ m An-NasI in Al-Kubra 5 :9 1

that calls to righteousness, enjoins all that is good and forbids evil in the manner Allah commanded, i And it is they who are the successful Ad-Dahhak said, "They are a special group of the Companions and a special group of those after them, that is those who perform Jihad and the scholars." The objective of this Ayah is that there should be a segment of this Muslim Ummah fulfilling this task, even though it is also an obligation on every member of this Ummah, each according to his ability. Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, i <JIL> .'.j i jvl ^ J*^~" Jb J «Whoever among you witnesses an evil, let him change it with his hand. If he is unable, then let him change it with his tongue. If he is unable, then let him change it with his heart, and this is the weakest faith.* In another narration, The Prophet jg said, JjLji »ljj v There is no faith beyond that, not even the weight of a mustard seed. o'21 Imam Ahmad recorded that Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman said that the Prophet jg said, jl <1>1 fS i/Ul jjp j l He in Whose Hand is my soul! You will enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, or Allah shall send down a punishment from Him to you. Then, you will supplicate to Him, but He will not accept your supplication. »|3 ' 111 At-Tabari 7 :92 121 Muslim 1 :69,70. 131 Ahmad 5:38.

234 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir At-Tirmidhi also collected this Hadith and said, " Hasan" There are many other Hadiths and Ayat on this subject, which will be explained later. The Prohibition of Division Allah said. <&& ** uvm%% s.# \y&m i And be not as those who divided and differed among themselves after the clear proofs had come to them} [3:105]. In this Ayah, Allah forbids this Ummah from imitating the division and discord of the nations that came before them. These nations also abandoned enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil, although they had proof of its necessity. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu 'Amir 'Abdullah bin Luhay said, "We performed Hajj with Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan. When we arrived at Makkah, he stood up after praying Zuhr and said, The Messenger of Allah jg said, <^' s4* 'J* f-te* Jt jit C£j ~ yj jiih - iL ovi jii. tii' jjiS/i iib^ f - ^uaji •di-j Vj J-fAA Vj V JiSJL "T7ie People of the Two Scriptures divided into seventy-two sects. This Ummah will divide into seventy-three sects, all in the Fire except one, that is, the Jama'dh.121 Some of my Ummah will be guided by desire, like one who is infected by rabies; no vein or joint will be saved from these desires. » [Mu'awiyah said next:] By Allah, O Arabs! If you do not adhere to what came to you from your Prophet jg then other people are even more prone not to adhere to it." 131 Similar was recorded by Abu Dawud14 ' from Ahmad bin

Hanbal and Muhammad bin Yahya. Tuhfat At-Ahwadhi 6 :390 (21 That is, the group that adheres to the teachings of the Prophet jg and his Companions Ahmad 4 : 102 f4 ' Abu Dawud 5:5.

The Benefits of Brotherly Ties and Unity and the Consequence of Division on the Day of the Gathering Allah said next, iOn the Day when some faces will become white and some faces zoill become black;) [3:106] on the Day of Resurrection. This is when the faces of followers of the Sunnah and the Jama'ah will radiate with whiteness, and the faces of followers of Bid.'ah (innovation) and division will be darkened, as has been reported from Ibn 'Abbas . Allah said, m f'P&& SSp Sj' 4As for those whose faces will become black (to them will be said): "Did you reject faith after accepting it?") Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "They are the hypocrites."121 prc \},Z) iThcn taste the torment (in Hell) for rejecting faith,) and this description befits every disbeliever. i - «• •» "if .' / .< .>> >> • ^ y jib jy Wjf iAnd for those whose faces will become white, they will be in Allah's mercy (Paradise), therein they shall dwell forever.) in Paradise, where they will reside for eternity and shall never desire to be removed. Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi recorded that Abu Ghalib said, "Abu Umamah saw heads (of the Khawarij sect) hanging on the streets of Damascus. He commented, The Dogs of the Fire and the worst dead people under the cover of the sky. The best dead men are those whom these have killed.' He then recited, Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :464. Editor's note: Although this statement is very popular, if it is not fabricated, it is among the weakest kinds of narrations , all of its chains resting upon a narrator are well-known for fabrication ^ Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :465

236 Tafsfr Ibn Kathfr •*>-*> yw {S.r iOn the Day (i.e. the Day of Resurrection) when some faces will become white and somefaces will become black;} until the end of the Ayah. I said to Abu Umamah, 'Did you hear this from the Messenger of Allah?' He said, If 1 only heard it from the Messenger of Allah once, twice, thrice, four times, or seven times, I would not have narrated it to you.' " At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan.' Ibn Majah121 and Ahmad*3 ' recorded similarly. Allah said, . - -y'i'. ^S} iThese are the Ayat ofAllah. We recite them to you meaning, These are the verses of Allah, His proofs and signs that We reveal to you, O Muhammad,' iin truth making known the true reality of this world and the Hereafter. tilt i/. «&' iand Allah wills no injustice to the Alamitt .} for He never treats them with injustice. Rather, He is the Just Ruler Who is able to do everything and has knowledge of everything. Therefore, He does not need to treat any of His creatures with injustice, and this is why He said next, 4 4 £&& iand to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the Earth.}, they are all His servants and His property, HsW&\$ iAnd all matters go back to Allah,} TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8:351. * Ibn Majah 1 :62. 131 Ahmad 5:256.

for His is the decision concerning the affairs of this life and the Hereafter, and His is the Supreme Authority in this life and the Hereafter. if- Jr 3 \$;:S>3 jK&Js f£i\$ <£ (& ^ & « p , \$M cis % P-j& t#\$ c 4-s^^ a\$N Sjars jf *4% ^ i . • . f 4110. You are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin Al-Ma'ruf (all that Islam has ordained) and forbid Al-Munkar (all that Islam has forbidden), and you believe in Allah. And had the People of the Scripture (jews and Christians) believed, it would have been betterfor than; among them are some who have faith, but most of them are Fdsiqun (rebellious) .} 4111. They ivill do you no harm, barring a trifling annoyance; and if they fight against you, they will show you their backs, and they will not be helped. 4 4112. They are stricken with humility wherever they may be, except when under a covenant (of protection)from Allah, and a covenant from men; they

have drawn on themselves the wrath of Allah, and destitution is put over them. This is because they disbelieved in the Aydt of Allah and killed the Prophets ivithout right. This is because they disobeyed (Allah) and used to transgress (the limits set by Allah).} Virtues ofthe UmmahofMuhammad the BestNation Elver Allah states that the Ummah of Muhammad jg is the best nation ever, 4o0, 4You are the best ofpeoples ever raised upfor mankind [3:1 10]. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah commented on this

Ayah, “(You, Muslims, are) the best nation of people for the people, you bring them tied in chains on their necks (capture them in war) and they later embrace Islam.” 111 Similar was said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi, ‘Ikrimah, ‘Ata’ and Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas that, £•* ji- jjj±) iYou are the best ofpeoples ever raised up for mankind;) means, the best of peoples for the people.12

The meaning of the Ayah is that the Ummah of Muhammad

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 935–956]

is the most righteous and beneficial nation for mankind. Hence Allah’s description of them, 4 -it J- o/ ffe) 4you ettjoin Al-Ma’riif and forbid Al-Munkar and believe in Allah) (3:110). Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi,*4 Ibn Majah,[5) and Al-Hakim recorded that Hakim bin Mu’awiyah bin Haydah narrated that his father said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, j* ?** fp fPj » ^ Irfr- jA’y «Yom are the final ofseventy ttations, you are the best and most honored among them to Allah. This is a well-known Hadith about which At-Tirmidhi said,“Hasan”, and which is also narrated from Mu’adh bin Jabal and Abu Said. The Ummah of Muhammad achieved this virtue because of its Prophet, Muhammad, peace be upon him, the most regarded of Allah’s creation and the most honored Messenger with Allah. Allah sent Muhammad jg with the perfect and complete Law that was never given to any Prophet or Messenger before him. In Muhammad’s Law, few deeds take the place of the many deeds that other nations performed. For instance, Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said, Fath Al-Bari 8 :72 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :472 , 473 Aljmad 5 :3 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :352 * Ibn Majah 2 :1433.

“The Messenger ofAllah said, ncftl if jS-\ L2 jU U vi_u{» a/ was given what no other Prophet before me ivas givenJ We said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! What is it?’ He said, Jl y’ijh C-iapij y\$ i j~>- “14^ «/ was g/i>en victory by fear, I was given the keys of the earth, I was called Ahmad, the earth was made a clean place for me (to pray and perform Tayammum with it) and my Ummah was made the best Ummah.*.” 111 The chain of narration for this Hadith is Hasan. There are several Hadlths that we should mention here. The Two Sahihs recorded that Az-Zuhri said that, Said bin Al-Musayyib said that Abu Hurayrah narrated to him, “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, -:ii i •” » ' » . J *,»’ *{ . s» - 1, ' • »_ tull Oyy *yj J* Jj-.bi) li .JUj i aJlP a ^ji * Cr ^Ui . OjtjA ^jl JU) @j.xJl j-; 5H5 4)1 3yj JU i jl 4)1 gal i4)l 3y*j : cJlJu . jl 4)1 gal !4)l 3yj U ! ijtai jLa*S/I ^ la »A group of seventy thousand from my Ummah will enter Paradise, while their faces are radiating, just like the moon when it is full.”Ukkashah bin Mihsan Al-Asadi stood up, saying, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Supplicate to Allah that I am one of them.’ The Messenger of Allah sg said, ‘O Allah! Make him one of them.’ A man from the Ansar also stood and said, ‘O Messenger ofAllah! Supplicate to Allah that I am one of them.’ The Messenger said, ‘Ukkashah has beaten you to it.’ I2’ 111 Ahmad 1 :98. 121 Path Al-Bari 1 1 :413 , MusUm 1:197.

Another Hadith that Establishes the Virtues of the Ummah of Muhammad (ﷺ) in this Life and the Hereafter. Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) saying, 'One-fourth of the residents of Paradise on the Day of Resurrection.' We said, 'Allahu Akbar'. He then said, 'One-third of the people.' We said, 'Allahu Akbar'. He then said, 'One-half.' 1*1 Imam Ahmad recorded the same Hadith with another chain of narration, 121 and this Hadith meets the criteria of Muslim in his Sahih. In the Two Sahih, it is recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said to us, 'Does it please you that you will be one-fourth of the people of Paradise?' We said, 'Allahu Akbar!' He added, 'Does it please you that you will be one-third of the people of Paradise?' We said, 'Allahu Akbar!' He said, 'One-half of the people of Paradise, yes.' 31 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Buraydah said that the Prophet said, 'The last of the nations to be judged is the Ummah of Muhammad (ﷺ)'. 111 Ahmad 3:346. 121 Ahmad 3:383 Fath Al-Bari 1:385, Muslim 1:200.

"The people of Paradise are one hundred and twenty rows, this Ummah takes up eighty of them." 1 Imam Ahmad also collected this Hadith through another chain of narration. 121 At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah 3 also collected this Hadith, and At-Tirmidhi said, 'This Hadith is Hasan'. 4] 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet (ﷺ) said, 'The last of the nations to be judged is the Ummah of Muhammad (ﷺ)'. 1 pXJAJ JA ULj ^jA y 1 tjji - xi. Xu ^jLJalJj t j 1XP . *_J llj Allt t<i «I've (Muslims) are the last to come, but the foremost on the Day of Resurrection, and the first people to enter Paradise, although the former nations were given the Scriptures before us and we after them. Allah gave us the guidance of truth that they have been disputing about. This (Friday) is the Day that they have been disputing about, and all the other people are behind us in this matter: the Jews' (day of congregation is) tomorrow (Saturday) and the Christians' is the day after tomorrow (Sunday). Al-Bukhari 5 and Muslim 16 collected this Hadith. Muslim recorded Abu Hurayrah saying that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, 'The last of the nations to be judged is the Ummah of Muhammad (ﷺ)'. 3 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:256 Ibn Majah 2:134. Al-Bukhari no. 896, 3486 and 3487. Muslim no. 855. 7 Muslim no. 855

These and other Hadiths conform to the meaning of the Ayah, cf <L>sifa oi>t iil 'ji- ^Lt) iYou are the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; you enjoin Al-Ma'ruf (all that Islam has ordained) and forbid Al-Munkar (all that Islam has forbidden), and you believe in Allah). Therefore, whoever among this Ummah acquires these qualities, will have a share in this praise. Qatadah said, "We were told that Umar bin Al-Khattab recited this Ayah [3:110] during a Hajj that he performed, when he saw that the people were rushing. He then said, 'Whoever likes to be among this [praised] Ummah, let him fulfill the condition that Allah set in this Ayah.' Ibn Jarir recorded this. Those from this Ummah who do not acquire these qualities will be just like the People of the Scriptures whom Allah criticized, when He said, 'They did not forbid one another from the Munkar which they committed...' [5:79]. This is the reason why, after Allah praised the Muslim Ummah with the qualities that He mentioned, He criticized the People of the Scriptures and chastised them, saying, 'And had the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians) believed) [3:110], in what was sent down to Muhammad (ﷺ). It would have been better for them; among them are some who have faith, but most of them are Fdsiqiin

(rebellious).) Therefore only a few of them believe in Allah and in what was sent down to you and to them. The majority of them follow deviation, disbelief, sin and rebellion. (i| At-Tabari 7 :102

243Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) The Good News that Muslims will Dominate the People of the Book While delivering the good news to His believing servants that victory and dominance will be theirs against the disbelieving, atheistic People of the Scriptures, Allah then said, V p efeZ 43 ZJ&%)They will do you no harm, barring a trifling annoyance; and if they fight against you, they will show you their backs, and they will not be helped .> (3:1 1 1] This is what occurred, for at the battle of Khaybar, Allah brought humiliation and disgrace to the Jews. Before that, the Jews in Al-Madlnah, the tribes of Qaynuqa', Nadir and Qurayzah, were also humiliated by Allah. Such was the case with the Christians in the area of Ash-Sham later on, when the Companions defeated them in many battles and took over the leadership of Ash-Sham forever. There shall always be a group of Muslims in Ash-Sham area until 'Isa, son of Maryam, descends while they are like this [on the truth, apparent and victorious]. 'Isa will at that time rule according to the Law of Muhammad break the cross, kill the swine, banish the Jizyah and only accept Islam from the people. Allah said next. uj Jjji jtji- c-f. ilndignity is put over them wherever they may be, except when under a covenant (of protection) from Allah, and a covenant from men;) meaning, Allah has placed humiliation and disgrace on them wherever they may be, and they will never be safe, iexcept when under a covenantfrom Allah,) under the Dhimmah (covenant of protection) from Allah that requires them to pay the Jizyah (tax, to Muslims,) and makes them subservient to Islamic Law.)and a covenant from men;) meaning, covenant from men,

such as pledges of protection and safety offered to them by Muslim men and women, and even a slave, according to one of the sayings of the scholars. Ibn 'Abbas said that, iJ* \$ \$ Si 4except when under a covenant from Allah, and a covenant from men;} refers to a covenant of protection from Allah and a pledge of safety from people.111 Similar was said by Mujahid, ikrimah, 'Ata', Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas. 121 Allah's statement, 4*"" Cii i<%}%¥ ithey have drawn on themselves the wrath ofAllah,} means, they earned Allah's anger, which they deserved, *\$. zj/i} iatid destitution is put over them}, meaning they deserve it by decree and legislatively. Allah said next, 4This is because they disbelieved in the Ayat ofAllah and killed the Prophets without right.} meaning, what drove them to this was their arrogance, transgression and envy, earning them humiliation, degradation and disgrace throughout this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, 4This is because they disobeyed and used to transgress (the limits set by Allah).} meaning, what lured them to disbelieve in Allah's Ayat and kill His Messengers, is the fact that they often disobeyed Allah's commands, committed His prohibitions and transgressed His set limits. We seek refuge from this behavior, and Allah Alone is sought for each and every type of help. 111 At-Tabari 7:112. Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :480,481

245Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) cmm k> sim •*ss / ^^ »/ S * * JA ^ / ^// ^ 4 GilJi^S'^jjJL^ StfjSfc ^ &:v2 is £#is;3 f<» »< ••••*?''.£. 4 •*-' -•} f -i tf ';' > •< . ^{ "x «5—,»A-0 \jA^>J'JUJ—aJo;j'-' -l^ujOi. iij^ /i.»-•»n12j all^' •>- ,t> - L-*^ 'V * r*' *t i -7i *T |^}J ^-dc- 4A1 ') x«-,i.^4jii <}s~yj P £ !£J #» yl*1» 0_y^l 4i> *J*' jiiij lEli <1\ ,;&> & &\$& o<3 4 £5 £j Si)<> < -ff *r * Wst' •}jt£=*i > ^ j; 'j'*-"" 0^ ^ ,^^niljl ^L..Ui <iilj ^ p j 1ST ^ir ,U jQt 4£>i Jutf; ££ ojlXu L. Ji. .«",ojj^S- 0j3' jyyJ' ,*j> 4 £.>* !>_}* c-.lj yj ^ gy dj ^i;li^ ipi ^ #3; # 4^;oA£ 4123. No/ all of them are alike ; a party o/ //ie People of the Scripture stand for the right, they recite the verses of Allah during the hours of the night, prostrating

themselves in prayer.} 4224. They believe in Allah and the Last Day; they enjoin Al- Ma'riif and forbid Al-Munkar ; and they hasten in (all) good works; and they are among the righteous. 4225. And whatever good they do, nothing will be rejected of them; for Allah knows well the Muttaqfn (the pious).} 4116. Surely, those who disbelieve, neither their properties nor their offspring will avail them against Allah. They are the dwellers of the Fire, therein they will abide.}

iThey believe in Allah and the Last Day; they enjoin Al-Ma'ruf and forbid Al-Munkar; and they hasten in (all) good works; and they are among the righteous^ [3:1 14]. This is the same type of people mentioned at the end of the Surah; if e; if tiM a ja i!& iAnd there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah.} [3:199]. Allah said here, & jf ji Cj} iAnd whatever good they do, nothing will be rejected of them;} [3:115] meaning, their good deeds will not be lost with Allah. Rather, He will award them the best rewards, %} ifor Allah knows well the Muttaqin (the pious).} for no deed performed by any person ever escapes His knowledge, nor is any reward for those who do good deeds ever lost with Him. Allah mentions the disbelieving polytheists: i“kL fa £ ^ J} in neither their properties nor their offspring will avail them against Allah} [3:116]. meaning, nothing can avert Allah's torment and punishment from striking them, iThey are the dwellers of the Fire, therein they will abide.} The Parable of What the Disbelievers Spend in This Life Allah gave a parable for what the disbelievers spend in this life, as Mujahid, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi said.*11 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :493

tjji go Cull _»jci 4 iiy^t U <\$77ie likeness of what they spend in this world is the likeness of a wind of Sir a frigid wind, as Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabf bin Anas and others have said. 1 ' 'Ata' said that Sir, means, 'cold and snow. Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid are also reported to have said that Sir means, 'fire'.' * This latter meaning does not contradict the meanings we mentioned above, because extreme cold weather, especially when accompanied by snow, burns plants and produce, and has the same effect fire has on such growth. 4'ZJOijfc \Jjii Zjj- ilt struck the harvest of a people who did wrong against themselves and destroyed ify [3 : 1 17] by burning. This Ayah mentions a calamity that strikes produce that is ready to harvest, destroying it by burning and depriving its owner of it when he needs it the most. Such is the case with the disbelievers, for Allah destroys the rewards for their good deeds in this life, just as He destroyed the produce of the sinner because of his sins. Both types did not build their work on firm foundations. iAnd Allah wronged them not, but they wronged themselves.> oi; a \$4 c& 4a 4 •&/, # &L '-a 01 p&Z (Ujjii jp £j « *£\$ lj& ffcaj oA& fiU % *Vi1 pa~i ol y'i 'Pa 'fy j* 4^*1 hi JjbVl Iyat- 4 iy^jj ij}— oij ^ aa a? pa of) pa <0- 41?:sp afa.an i\ hz 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :494,495. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :496 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :495.

249Surah 3. Al 'Imran (Part-4 ill8. O you who believe! Take not as (your) Bitanah (advisors, helpers) those other than your own, since they will not fail to do their best to corrupt you. They desire to harm you severely. Hatred has already appeared from their mouths, but what their breasts conceal is far worse. Indeed We have made plain to you the Ayat if you understand .£> \$119. Lo! You are the ones who love them but they love you not, and you believe in all the Scriptures. And when they meet you, they say, "We believe." But when they are alone, they bite their Anamil at you in rage. Say: "Perish in your rage. Certainly, Allah knows what is in the breasts (all the secrets)."4 4120. If a good befalls you,

it grieves them, but if some evil overtakes you, they rejoice at it. But if you remain patient and have Taqia, not the least harm will their cunning do to you. Surely, Allah surrounds all that they do.

The Prohibition of Taking Advisors From Among the Disbelievers Allah forbids His believing servants from taking the hypocrites as advisors, so that the hypocrites do not have the opportunity to expose the secrets of the believers and their plans against their enemies. The hypocrites try their very best to confuse, oppose and harm the believers any way they can, and by using any wicked, evil means at their disposal. They wish the very worst and difficult conditions for the believers. Allah said, *oi ^ 4Take not as (your) Bitanah those other than your own* [3 :118], in reference to taking followers of other religions as consultants and advisors, for advisors of a certain person have access to his most secret affairs. Al-Bukhari and An-Nasal recorded that, Abu Said said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *3- ya ^ < aIIp AjU t aJIp Auowj*

«Alldh has not sent any Prophet nor was there any Khalifah but they have two types of advisors, one that commands him with righteousness and advises it, and another that commands him with evil and advises him with it. Only those whom Allah gives immunity are immune .d' Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abi Ad-Dahqanah said, "Umar bin Al-Khattab was told, There is young man here from the people of Hlrah (in Iraq, who were Christians) who is a proficient scribe. Why do you not appoint him as a scribe?" "Umar said, 1 would then be taking advisors from among the disbelievers."*2 ' This Ayah and the stoiy about TJmar testify to the fact that Muslims are not allowed to use Ahl Adh- Dhimmah to be scribes in matters that affect the affairs of Muslims and expose their secrets, for they might convey these secrets to combatant disbelievers. This is why Allah said, isince they will not fail to do their best to corrupt you . They desire to harm you severely .)» Allah then said, fall jJiK^ lLjJj JLS\$ iHatred has already appearedfrom their mouths, but what their breasts conceal isfar worse. meaning, enmity appears on their faces and in what they sometimes utter, as well as, the enmity they have against Islam and its people in their hearts. Since this fact is apparent to every person who has sound comprehension, therefore, 4Indeed We have made plain to you the Aydt if you understand.} Allah said next, 40/ You are the ones who love them but they love you not}. Fath Al-Bdri 13 :201 , An-Nasal 7 :158 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2:500.

251Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) meaning, O believers! You like the hypocrites because you think they are believers, for they pretend to be so, but they do not like you publicly or secretly. iAtid you believe in all the Scriptures} meaning, you have no doubt in any part of Allah's Book, while the hypocrites have deep doubts, confusion and reservations about it. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, iJ Jill iand you believe in all the Scriptures,} means, you believe in your Book, their Book, and the previous Books, while the hypocrites disbelieve in your Book, and this is why they deserve that you dislike them instead of them disliking you. Ibn Jarir collected this statement. tji tjg. fit; £t; \%\$\$ tit> iAnd when they meet you, they say, "We believe." But when they are alone, they bite their Anamil at you in rage .} The word Anamil, means the tips of the fingers, as Qatadah stated. This is the behavior of the hypocrites who pretend to be believers and kind when they are with the believers, all the while concealing the opposite in their hearts in every respect. This is the exact situation that Allah describes, St JjbV' (SSit. '•yjc- ijU. ti^j^> iBut zohen they are alone, they bite their Andtnil at you in rage and rage is extreme anger and fury. Allah said to them, iSay: "Perish in your rage. Certainly, Allah knows

what is in the breasts (all the secrets)."} for no matter how much you envy the believers and feel rage ,
1] At-Tabari 7:149. 121 At-Tabari 7:153.

253 Surah 3. At 'Imran (Part-4) ou&ifc- i' uj >JJ *u\ iyL>\i 4J31 . *r » 2'-i?~; tt-'t > '< -'>.:> juy-
iljCaj £>1,\$2\$jp4j'io^v s 6jk*£l3 i"JJ J-jj 4'y' jujli-iy\fc-Ji 'j / > , f. ->/ • /,>4 » ,</ X- -irr- _/• j'(lf
uj®>S/T jO'jU-lJ'4k aU _j@ ^\c£k;\$ kii iykijilkakiikCilip^ii_>14=ij 'iijkC \a Allah then mentions

the story of Uhud, the defeat that He tested the believers with, His distinguishing the believers from the hypocrites and their patience. \iyZ ik' (si CjjM. iD> c— il ^CU. t£i; kfj Stik J ,£*«- 4jil y-U- j-***> -ulj
'T 5/>3 j£ij ki ijiiii 4121 . A/id (remember) when you left your household in the morn- ing to post the believers at their stations for the battle (of Uhud). And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knoiver.} 4222. When two parties from among you were about to lose heart, but Allah was their Wall (Supporter and Protector). And in Allah should the believers put their trust. 4223. And Allah has already made you victorious at Badr, when you were a zveak little force. So have Taqwd of Allah that you may be grateful .> The Battle ofUhud According to the majority of scholars, these Aydt are describing the battle of Uhud, as Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said.

The battle of Uhud Tnfsir Ibn Katfir year of Hijrah. Allah knows best. Of the month of Shawwal, and Allah Kno srsx tssss Makkan leaders and t e ^ ^ «Spend this money on Badr to demand from A fy spent the money from fightingMuhammad! COnsequeny,^y^P biiized^ forces the caravan on warfare “P around the city). They tad^theA^tohtoto^w^J marched unta ^gathered three thousa Madinah. The Messenger of Allah camped near Uhud facing - he fmished with it, he jg led the Friday prayer an from Bani An-Najjar performed the funeral prayer f ^ asked the Muslims called Malik bin 'Amr. The Prophet t the disbelievers, or for advice, if they s J. d ,^i . Abdullah bin Ubayy (the chief fortify themselvesm M-Madinah.^d ^ A1.M dlnah , hypocrite) advised tha y Al-Madlnah, the siege saving that it the disbeliever. lay stege to« ^ [hat it would be greatly dlsadyantageou ^^ would face off with they decide to attack A - cou,d throw rocks at them them, while women and decide to return to Makkah, from above their heads; and rf th y A some companionswho they would return wrdr fadure.^ ^^ Muskms did not attend the Hichelievers. should go out to Uhuiteme ^ hig home , put on his The Messenger of ^ f anions were weary then and shield and came ou ^ compei the Messenger of Allah to go said to each other,. Did P f Allah, if you wish, we will remsdn^in Al-Madlnah^ Tbe'Messenger of Allah *S said, . u«J Jill '(fry-^^ *4 b *\$ Ut iIt is not for a Prophet to wear his shield for war then lay down his ams before Allah decides in hisfavor, l'l Recorded by Ai-Bukhari in abridged form, and At-Tabarani and others recorded the story with authentic connected chains

The Messenger of Allah sg marched with a thousand of his Companions. When they reached the Shawt area, 'Abdullah bin Ubayy went back to Al-Madinah with a third of the army, claiming he was angry the Prophet sg did not listen to his advice. He and his supporters said, “Ifwe knew that you would fight today, we would have accompanied you. However, we do not think that you will fight today.” The Messenger of Allah jg marched until he reached the hillside in the area of Uhud, where they camped in the valley with Mount Uhud behind them. The Messenger ofAllah sg said, *J iLi)L c **U jL>-t N® «No one startsfighting until I issue the command to fight The Messenger0 prepared his forces for battle, and his army was seven hundred men. He appointed 'Abdullah bin Jubayr, from Bani 'Amr bin 'Awf, to lead the archers who were fifty men. The Prophet0 said to them, ill £jl)l oilS i3J i p.^Lj fj* j tllp jS j.Ul

l-iL>w Ij^olj j i UmIp j\ "Keep the horsemen away from us, and be aware that we might be attacked from your direction. If victory was for or against us, remain in your positions. And even if you see us being picked up by birds, do not abandon your positions .’ll The Prophet ^g wore two protective shields and gave the flag to Mus'ab bin ‘Umayr of Bani ‘Abd Ad-Dar. The Prophet^ also allowed some young men to participate in fighting, but not others, whom he allowed to participate in the battle of Al-Khandaq two years later. The Quraysh mobilized their forces of three thousand men with two hundred horsemen on each flank. They appointed Khalid bin Al-Walld to lead the right side of the horsemen and ‘Ikrimah Ibn Abi Jahl on the left side. They also gave their grand flag to the tribe of Bani ‘Abd Ad-Dar. Allah willing, we will mention the details of this battle later on, if Allah wills. Allah said here, ajiL. isp bt iAnd (remember) lohc n you left your household in the morning to post the believers at their stations for the battle^ [3:121],

designating them to various positions, dividing the army to the left and right sides and placing them wherever you command them. 4'1~£ g? 4And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knmver} He hears what you say and knows what you conceal in your hearts. Allah said next, »fe^ c.,« iWhen hvo parties from among you were about to lose heart,} [3:122]. Al-Bukhari recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “The Ayah, 4&Z oil iifr iWhen two parties from among you were about to lose heart was revealed about us, [the two Muslim tribes of] Bani Harithah and Bani Salamah. I (or we) would not be pleased if it was not revealed, because Allah said in it, 4ty) 4but Allah was their Wall (Supporter and Protector)} [3:122].”111 Muslim recorded this Hacıith from Sufyan bin ‘UyaynahJ2 ' Reminding the Believers of Their Victory at Badr Allah said, XJLL^ All' f JUij^ iAnd Allah has already made you victorious at Badr,}[3:123] meaning, during the battle of Badr, which occurred on a Friday, the seventeenth of Ramadan, in the second year of Hijrah.

The day of Badr is known as Yawm Al-Furqan [the Day of the Clarification], by which Allah gave victory and dominance to Islam and its people and disgraced and destroyed Shirk, even though the Muslims were few. The Muslims numbered FathAl-Bari 8:63 I2 * Muslim 4:1948.

257Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) three hundred and thirteen men, with two horses and seventy camels. The rest were foot soldiers without enough supplies for the battle. The enemy army consisted of nine hundred to a thousand men, having enough shields and supplies, battle-ready horses and even various adornments. However, Allah gave victory to His Messenger jg, supported His revelation, and illuminated success on the faces of the Prophet jg and his following. Allah also brought disgrace to Shayatan and his army. This is why Allah reminded His believing servants and pious party of this favor, / *»; Z •> V X A'p JLL;- All' (1 iAttd Allah has already made you victorious at Badr, when you were a weak little force}, when you were few then. This Ayah reminds them that victory is only from Allah, not because of a large army and adequate supplies. This is why Allah said in another Ayah, i..and on the day of Hunayit (battle) when you rejoiced at your great number, but it availed you naught [9:25], until. iAnd Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful} [9:27]. Badr is an area between Makkah and Al-Madinah and is known by the well that bears its name, which in turn was so named after Badr bin An-Narayn, the person who dug the well. iflplpi 'M 4So have Taqzvd of Allah that you may be grateful.} [3:123], means, fulfill the obligations of His obedience. & o;p: pj 'fP. i P-P-i \$ PdA '}>[] 'Pf&i & pi i-Hi pj 'pp 'i* [Ujy iA fiPj /p o! xs. & 'Jj jpd Cj pji vpAj 'p izA* "1 <» 4 Cj cJpS\ 4 C Aii Af. pP. j' p- i" 'i-

4 J4 jj >;Vf <124. (Remember) when you said to the believers, "Is it not enough for you that your Lord should help you with three thousand angels setit down?"} 4125. "But, if you hold on to patience and have Taqwd, and the enemy comes rushing at you; your Lord will help you with five thousand angels having marks (of distinction)."} 4126. Allah made it not but as a message of good news for you and as an assurance to your hearts. And there is no victory except from Allah, the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} 4127. That He might cut off a part of those who disbelieve, or expose them to infamy, so that they retirefrustrated.} 4128. Not for you is the decision; whether He turns in mercy to (pardon) them or punishes them; verily, they are the xorongdoers .} 4129. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. He forgives whom He wills, and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} The Support of the Angels The scholars of Tafsir differ over whether the promise contained in these Ayat referred to the battle of Badr or Uhud. The FirstView There are two opinions about this, one of them saying that Allah's statement, Jja3 4(Remember) when you said to the believers^ [3: 124], is related to His statement, ii' 4And Allah has already made you victorious at Badr} [3:123]. This was reported from Al-Hasan Al-Basri, 'Amr Ash-ShaToi, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and several others, ' Ibn Jarir also agreed *** Ibn Abi Hatim no. 519-521

with this opinion. 'Abbad bin MansQr said that Al-Hasan said that Allah's statement, 4^x3' 'Jt && <\$3S o'^3 i'> 4(Remember) when you said to the believers, "Is it not enough for you that your Lord should help you with three thousand angels?"} [3:124], is about the battle of Badr;' ' Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this statement. Ibn Abi Hatim then reported that 'Amr Ash-Shaloi said, "On

the day of Badr, the Muslims received information that Kurz

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 956–960]

bin Jabir (a prominent tribe chief) was aiding the idolators, and this news was hard on them, so Allah revealed; jj yd'» o' i'"Is it not enough for you that your Lord (Allah) should help you with three thousand angels sent down?"}, until, ihaving marks (of distinction)} [3:124,125]. The news of the defeat of the idolators [at Badr] reached Kurz and he did not reinforce them, and thus, Allah did not reinforce the Muslims with the five (thousands of angels)."} |2 ' As for Ar-RabT bin Anas, he said, "Allah supported the Muslims with one thousand (angels), then the number reached three thousand, then five thousand." ' If one asks, according to this opinion, how can we combine between this Ayah and Allah's statement about Badr, i(Remember) when you sought help of your Lord and He ansioered you (saying): "I will help you with a thousand angels, each behind the other (following one another) in succession."} [8:9], until, iiSfLU«^} At-Jabari 7:174. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :520. 131 At-Tabari 7 :178.

4 Verily! Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise}? We say that the one thousand mentioned here does not contradict the three thousand mentioned in the above Ayah [3:124], The word "in succession" means they follow each other and thus indicates that thousands more will follow them. The two Ayat above [8:9 and 3:124] are similar in meaning and it appears that they both were about the battle of Badr, because the angels did fight in the battle of Badr, as the evidence indicates. Allah knows best. Allah's statement, 4's^j o\ 4But ifyou hold on to patience and have Taqwd,} [3:125) means, if you observe patience while fighting the enemy, all the while fearing Me and obeying My command. Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl' and As-Suddi said that Allah's statement, ui ffijb iand they will come rushing>

means, they (angels) will rush to you instantaneously. 111 Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah means, “All at once”. It is also said that it means, before their anger subsides (against the disbelievers).¹²¹ The SecondView The second opinion stipulates that the promise mentioned here [concerning the angels participating in battle] is related to Allah’s statement, 4J&S) 5ojiK Up Oi 10 4And (remember) when you left your household in the morning to post the believers at their stationsfor the battle} of Uhud. However, we should add, the angels did not come to the aid of Muslims at Uhud, because Allah made it conditional, 4’^ 4^ 4But ifyou hold on to patience and have Taqwa} [3:125]. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :523,524. AMabari 7:182.

The Muslims were not patient at Uhud. Rather, they ran away and, consequently, did not receive the support of even one angel. Allah’s statement, iyour Lord will help you with five thousand angels having marks}, of distinction. Abu Ishaq As-Subay‘i said; from Harithah bin Mudarrib said that ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said, “The angels were distinguished by wearing white wool at Badr.” 111 The angels also had special markings distinguishing their horses. Allah said, if.p\$ 504,p tsA V> & Cj} iAllah made it not but as a message ofgood news for you and as an assurance to your hearts^ [3:126]. This Ayah means, “Allah sent down angels and told you about their descent to encourage you and to comfort and reassure your hearts. You should know that victory only comes from Allah and that if He willed, He would have defeated your enemy without you having to fight them.” For instance, Allah said after commanding the believers to fight, 5— Jb 5^ 4 y** o’?*-; J^iV «ii 4Qf*^ ^ Qpti iBut if it had been Allah’s will, He Himself could certainly have punished them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some ofyou with others. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost. He will guide them and set right their state. And admit them to Paradise which He has made known to them} [47:4-6]. This is why Allah said here, & X* j. % Cj 4 pjb p &A VI ‘if &£ Cj} Ibn Abi Hatim 2:525.

iAllah made it not but as a message ofgood news for you and as an assurance to your hearts. And there is no victory except from Allah, the All-Mighty, the All-Wise} [3:126]. This Ayah means, “Allah is the Almighty Whose power can never be undermined, and He has the perfect wisdom in His decrees and in all His decisions.” Allah said, Sj’ Si^ iThat He might cut offa part of those who disbelieve,} [3:127] meaning, out of His wisdom, He commands you to perform Jihad and to fight. Allah then mentions the various consequences of performing Jihad against the disbelievers. For instance, Allah said, iThat He might cut off a part...} meaning, to cause a part of a nation to perish, 4rr-p. \$ sj’ Si^ iof those who disbelieve, or expose them to infamy,} by disgracing them and forcing them to return with only their rage, having failed in their aim to harm you. This is why Allah said next, ior expose titem to infamy, so tluit they retire} to go back to their land, iZiJL} ifrustrated} without achieving their aims. Allah then mentions a statement that testifies that the decision in this life and the Hereafter is for Him Alone without partners, fit j.& fl} iNotfor you is the decision} [3:128] meaning, “The matter is all in My Hand.” Allah also said, 4\$l4> iSj fy}

iyour duty is only to convex/ (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning .} (13:40], and, iNot upon you is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He zoills.} [2:272], and, 4 o* cSJ-n >>* i-SJ-r V iVerily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills} [28:56] Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Allah’s statement, M > o?^ 4Nof /or yo» is the decision;}, means, “No part of the decision

regarding My servants is yours, except what I command

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 960–973]

you.” ‘ Allah then mentions the rest of the consequences of Jihad, in? * jfa iwl t ether He pardons them} concerning the acts of disbelief that they commit, thus delivering them from misguidance to the guidance. to ior punishes than;} in this life and the Hereafter because of their disbelief and errors, iverily, they are the wrongdoers}, and thus, they deserve such a fate. Al-Bukhari recorded that, Salim bin ‘Abdullah said that his father said that he heard the Messenger of Allah saying - when he raised his head from bowing in the second unit of the Fajr prayer - “O Allah! Curse so-and-so,” after saying; Sami’ Allahu Liman Hamidah, Rabbana wa lakal-Hamd. Thereafter, Allah revealed this Ayah, m At-Tabari 7 :195

iNot far you is the decision This was also recorded by An- Nasal . Imam Ahmad recorded that Salim bin ‘Abdullah said that his father said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, ‘jfa* y. Jri— y jaJI JUfijI i.U’iii :jjl 14I31. “V y. “O Allah! Curse so-and-so. O Allah! Curse Al-Haritlt bin Hisham. O Allah! Curse Sidmjl bin ‘Amr. O Allah! Curse Safwan bin Umayyah . Thereafter, this Ayah was revealed; ', Chfafa j\ fast. fay, >\ ty. fail ij. iNot far you is the decision; whether He turns in mercxj to (pardon) them or punishes them; verily, they are the wrongdoers> [3 :128], All these persons were pardoned (after they embraced Islam later on). Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that when Allah’s Messenger jte would supplicate against or for someone, he would do so when he was finished bowing and saying; Sami’ AUa.hu Liman Hamidah, Rabbana wa lakal-Hamd. He would then say, (the Qunu.t) a?’ y. y~r ‘fafa y. cfaj ^ git (*+11''' *4^ ‘ yt j.i*dh:LXi\j a, '> * . > “O Allah! Save Al-Walid bin Al-Waltd, Salamah bin Hisham, ‘Ayyash bin Abi Rabfah and the iveak and the helpless people among the faithful believers. O Allah! Be hard on the tribe of Mudar and let them suffer from years offamine like tlu it of the time of Yusuf. He would say this supplication aloud. He sometimes would supplicate during the Dawn prayer, “O Allah! Curse so-and-so 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :73. ^ An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 : 314 . •3| Ahmad 2 :93 .

(persons),” mentioning some Arab tribes. Thereafter, Allah revealed, \$Not for you is the decision . ^ (11 Al-Bukhari recorded that Hamid and Thabit said that, Anas bin Malik said that the Prophet jg was injured during the battle of Uhud and said, aHow can a people achieve success after having injured their Prophet?» Thereafter, it-J. jH\ 'j. iNot for you is the decision,} was revealed.,2' Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that, the Prophet’s front tooth was broken during the battle of Uhud and he also sustained injuries on his forehead until blood dripped on his face. The Prophet jg said, ft f ^ . »| • * > ^ ' I • ' a ' • * *1 *rj 'j* r+.j 'rfrn^ C/ - - aHow can a people achieve success after having done this to their Prophet who is calling them to their Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored?» Allah revealed. i 1&P * &Z> iNot for you is the decision; whether He turns in mercy to (pardons) them or punishes them; verily, they are the zorongdoers . ^*3 * Muslim also collected this Hadlth. |4) Allah then said, 4 Cj 4 C ^ Al-Bukhari no. 4560. 121 Fath Al-Bari 7 :365 131 Ahmad 3:99. Muslim no. 1791.

266 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir ^ Tv gjjp ^ 4And to Allah belongs Hr^ dl yy^ 5A^Si' cioliiojjJ/fyij .-,^^ &Ei»;«pfj / , < >f*irr •- „< » ^ , *45* / .- /t-'i i-" »-x r >-• ,<;•,•".< " j#5si {j™J <AaJ~y»J<JJJ>jjjUUoUi>-t&^ k-Z'tp'-j&JS fbV^:j 4 »tE\$ 4He forgives whom He wills, and punishes

whom He wills.} for His is the decision and none can resist His decision. Allah is never asked about what He does, while they will be asked, jj* ^bf iand Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful .} %f,jyX"i 'ii \Jilj tLCii \fkJt -5 \p?. <iM (\$£} # •\$,&&&& \$£& & *4 \$ 'M \$5 Wv^u1j CjjA OyU-lJt W^t* #2*5 ii)Ar** d[ij*>£y 44^ ^ 4^5 ££>»; 4ii <*' ijilu jl '>L<i)T?.,^j£Xm y>j 'jL<i £ d* U/-*i (*4> "1X>0 j-A" u4> 4 'K^oUi«!' f*-*ai ^4^- Ar^'" X* Ji 'Sf* ?-&> A, >4“ 4130. O t/ow who believe! Do not consume Riba doubled and multiplied, but fear Allah that you may be successful.} 4131. And fear the Fire, which is prepared for the all that is in the heavens and all that is in the Earth.} [3: 129], everything is indeed the property of Allah and all are servants in His Hand. i 0-4

disbelievers .) ^132. And obey and the Messenger that you may obtain mercy . 4133. And march forth in the way (which leads to) forgiveness from your Lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth, preparedfor the Muttaqin (the pious.) 4134. Those who spend (in Allah's cause) in prosperity and in adversity, who repress anger, and who pardon men; verily, Allah loves the Muhsimn (the good-doers.) 4135. And those who, when they have committed Fahishah (immoral sin) or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgiveness for their sins ; and none can forgive sins but Allah, and do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know.) 4236. For such, the reward is forgiveness from their Lord, and Gardens with rivers flowing underneath (Paradise), wherein they shall abide forever. Hoio excellent is this reward for the doers (ofgood.) Interest (R&d) is Prohibited Allah prohibits His believing servants from dealing in Riba and from requiring interest on their capital, just as they used to do during the time of Jahiliyyah. For instance, when the time to pay a loan comes, the creditor would say to the debtor, “Either pay now, or the loan will incur interest.” If the debtor asks for deferment of the loan, the creditor would require interest and this would occur year after year until the little capital becomes multiplied many times. Allah also commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him so that they may achieve success in this life and the Hereafter. Allah also threatens them with the Fire and warns them against it, saying, 43ri.TLtyT*} p Jj-jl'S iAnd fear the Fire, which is prepared for the disbelievers. And obey Allah and the Messenger that you may obtain mercy.) [3:131,1321.

268 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr TheEncouragment toDo Good forwhich Paradise is the Result Allah encourages His servants to perform righteous deeds and to rush to accomplish the acts of obedience. Allah said, iAnd march forth iti the way (which leads to) forgiveness from your lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth, preparedfor the Muttaqin (the pious)} [3:133]. Just as the Fire was prepared for the disbelievers. It was reported that the meaning of Allah’s statement. ias wide as the heavens and the earth} draws the attention to the spaciousness of Paradise. For instance, Allah said in another Ayah, while describing the couches of Paradise, ilined with silk brocade} (55:54], so what about their outer covering? It was also said that Paradise is as wide as its length, because it is a dome under the Throne. The width and length of a dome or a circle are the same in distance. This is supported bywhat is found in the Sahih; . . > . r •) ‘ jtjff *When you ask Allah for Paradise, ask Him for Al-Firdaws which is the highest and best part ofParadise. From it originate the rivers of Paradise, and above it is the Throne of the Most Beneficent (Allah)J This Ayah [3:133 above] is similar to Allah’s statement in Surat Al-Hadid. jU-jf frfo ’&> cA Jl m Path Al-Bari 6:14.

iRace with one another in hastening towards forgiveness from your Lord (Allah), and Paradise the width whereof is as the ividth of the heaven and the Earth} [57:21]. Al-Bazzar recorded that Abu

Hurayrah said that a man came to the Messenger of Allah and asked him, about Allah's statement, {Paradise as wide as the heavens and the Earth} [3:133]; "Where is the Fire then?" The Prophet ﷺ said, "When the night comes, it overtakes everything, so where is the day? The man said, "Where Allah wants it to be." The Prophet ﷺ said, tfeje. !>jS5 j&I Jlj j «Similarly , the Fire is where Allah wants it to be.® 11 ' This Hadith has two possible meanings. First, when we do not see the night during the day, this does not mean that the day is not somewhere else, even though we cannot see it. Such is the case with Hell-fire, for it is where Allah wants it to be. The second meaning is that when the day overcomes this part of the world, the night overtakes the other part. Such is the case with Paradise, for it is in the utmost heights above the heavens and under the Throne. The width of Paradise is, as Allah stated, {whereof is as the width of the heaven and the Earth} [57:21]. The Fire, on the other hand, is in the lowest of lows. Therefore, Paradise being as wide as the heavens and Earth does not contradict the fact that the Fire exists wherever Allah wills it to be. Allah said, while describing the people of Paradise, m KashfAl-Astar3 :43

iThose who spend (in Allah's cause) in prosperity and in adversity> (3:134), in hard times and easy times, while active (or enthusiastic) and otherwise, healthy or ill, and in all conditions, just as Allah said in another Ayah, iThose who spend their wealth (in Allah's cause) by night and day, in secret and in public> (2:274) These believers are never distracted from obeying Allah, spending on what pleases Him, being kind to His servants and their relatives, and other acts of righteousness. Allah said, iwho repress anger, and who pardon men;} [3:134] for when they are angry, they control their anger and do act upon it. Rather, they even forgive those who hurt them. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, *The strong person is not he who is able to physically overcome people. The strong person is he who overcomes his rage when he is angry .o' 1 ' This Hadith is also recorded in the Two Sahihs. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, if. lij CA-i if ;^4—; Ji-* fA* j) - _ \y.s. *ij>- Sii -ll* 1 U tjLf- Jili- fyr if J) f-fr <UILI "He who gives time to a debtor orforgives him, then Allah will save him from the heat of Jaltannam (Hell-fire). Behold! The deeds of Paradise are difficult to reach, for they are on top of a m Ahmad 2:236. 121 Fath Al-Bari 10:535, Muslim 4 :2014.

hill, while the deeds of the Fire are easy to find in the lozoland. The happy person is he who is saved from the tests. Verily, there is no dose of anything better to Allah than a dose of rage that the servant controls, and whenever the servant of Allah controls it, he will be internally filled with faith . [1 ' This Hadith was recorded by Imam Ahmad, its chain of narration is good, it does not contain any dispranged narrators, and the meaning is good. Imam Ahmad recorded that Sahl bin Mu'adh bin Anas said that his father said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «JL£ jl Ifs. 'jij jjaS rfi •ili jj>,Jl y «Whoever controlled rage ivhile able to act upon it, then Allah will call him while all creation is a witness, until He gives him the choice of any of the Hiiris (fair females with wide, lovely eyes - as matesfar the pious) he zvishes. Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah collected this Hadith, 121 which At-Tirmidhi said was "Hasan Gharib". Ibn Marduyah recorded that Ibn 'Umar said that the Messenger of Allah said, «4)l tali- y» jjiit - t J . 'f-j'r yt -V- U» uThrc is not a dose ofanything tlwt the servant takes which is better than a dose of control of rage that he feels, when he does it seeking Allah's Face.»13' Ibn Jarir and Ibn Majah141 also collected this Hadith. Allah said, iwho repress anger4 meaning, they do not satisfy their rage upon people. Rather, they refrain from harming them and await their rewards with Allah, the

Exalted and Most Honored. Allah then said, 111 Ahmad 1 :327. *21 Ahmad 3:438,440, Abu Dawud 5 : 137,7tih/af Al-Ahwadhi 6:139, Ibn Majah 2:1400. 131 Ahmad 2:128. 141 Ibn Majah 2:1401.

Tafsir Ibn Kalhir²⁷² iand who pardon menfy They forgive those who treat them with injustice. Therefore, they do not hold any ill feelings about anyone in their hearts, and this is the most excellent conduct in this regard. This is why Allah said, J ii iverily, Allah loves the Muhsinitt (the good-doersfy. This good conduct is a type of Ihscin [excellence in the religion]. There is a Hadith that reads, if «<ul 4jUj <U5° y “I swear regarding three matters: no charity shall ever decrease the wealth; whenever one forgives people, then Allah will magnify his honor; and he who is humblefor Allah, then Allah will raise his rank.*[li Allah said. 4And those who, when they have committed Fahishah or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgivenessfor their sins [3:135]. Therefore, if they commit an error they follow it with repentance and ask forgiveness. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, j j w— ‘si— . J • Jlii Lii ^JaP Jj «. 4j JL>*\\jj » iJJI Cj aJ jl pip I J 3^ ^ Cii J^ ^ #^apU Lji ol^p j ! Jlii lii ^J^p pi i xZjytfi- Jj > , 'c *: ' (* > , »s , i r ^ *,*,*sZJJA* jj 1 p-S-lf.il i,Aj J Uj a) jl (_£jip j^ip Jp AUl [11 Ahmad 4 :231

•*Li L* ^JuaJ “A man once committed an error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant committed an error and knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishesfor the error. I haveforgivenMy servant.' The man committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishes for the sin . I have forgiven My servant.' The man committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Who forgives or punishes for the error. I have forgiven my servant.' He then committed another error and said, 'O Lord! I committed an error, so forgive me.' Allah said, 'My servant knew that he has a Lord Wlw forgives or punishes for the error. Bear witness that I have forgiven My servant, so let him do whatever he likes. 'n* 11 similar narration was collected in the SahihP ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “I was told that when the Ayah, i jl i tfs til iAnd those who, when they have committed Fdhishah or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgivenessfor their sins,} was revealed, Iblis (Shayatan) cried.” ‘3| Allah’s statement, 4and none can forgive sins but Allah}, means that none except Allah forgives sins. Allah said, 4And do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know}, 111 Ahmad 2:296. 121 Fath Al-Bari 13:474. ‘Abdul-Razzaq 1:133.

275L/m mi » i r underneath (Paradise)} carrying all kinds of drinks, 4Q. iwherein they shall abideforever and ever, 4How excellent is this reward for the doers Allah praises Paradise in this part of the Ayah. Ji' jt SJBfi \\£% i; *&*> Jb X. flSV' liljjj id— Xii 0^ JjWJOLii} 44 ^^ ^ 4l;s ip; St^ (j&\\ iif Ju CJj il»J' 1j3o-j3 jl «*>' (jlilJL iii tjSij J Jj ^ £p~ j>-j T-^" jiiij 4137. Many similar ways (and mishaps of life) were faced [by nations (believers and disbelievers) that have passed away] before you, so travel through the earth, and see what ivas the end of those who denied .} 4138. This is a plain statement for mankind, a guidance and instruction for the Muttaqin .} 4139. So do not become weak, nor be sad, and you ivill be triumphant ifyou are indeed believers .} 4140. Ifa wound has touched you, be sure a similar wound has touched the others . And so are the days, that We give to men by turns, that Allah may know (test) those who believe, and that He may take martyrsfrom among you . And Allah likes not the wrongdoers . } 4141. And that Allah may test those who believe and destroy the disbelievers.}. 4142.

Do you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who performed Jihad and knows (tests) those who are patient?} 4143. You did indeed wish for death before you met it. Now

276 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir you have seen it openly with your own eyes.} TheWisdomBehindthe Losses MuslimsSufferedDuring Uhud Allah states to His believing servants who suffered losses in

the battle of Uhud, including seventy dead,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 973–1011]

oli- ji} iMany similar ways (and mishaps of life) were faced before you}, for the previous nations who followed their Prophets before you, they too suffered losses. However, the good end was theirs, and the ultimate defeat was for the disbelievers. This is why Allah said, ^so travel through the earth, and see what was the end of those who denied}. Allah said next, iThis is a plain statementfor mankind}, meaning, the Qur'an explains the true reality of things and narrates how the previous nations suffered by the hands of their enemies. iAnd a guidance and instruction} for the Qur'an contains the news of the past, and, 4guidance for your hearts, }and instruction for the Muttaqin} to discourage committing the prohibited and forbidden matters. Allah comforts the believers by saying, }So do not become weak}, because ofwhat you suffered,

<JSfU' opi\ p^j i>5^ inor be sad, and you will be triumphant if you are indeed believers}. for surely, the ultimate victory and triumph will be yours, O believers. <jU;pp Ji SZgpzz& ilf a wound has touched you, be sure a similar wound has touched the others [3:140]. Therefore, the Ayah says, if you suffered injuries and some of you were killed, then your enemies also suffered injuries and fatalities. iAnd so are the days, that We give to men by turns} , and at times - out of wisdom - We allow the enemy to overcome you, although the final good end will be yours. J8pip iand that Allah may know (test) those who believe,} meaning, "So that We find out who would be patient while fighting the enemies," according to Ibn 'Abbas. i-yppspp iand that He may take martyrsfrom among you} those who would be killed in Allah's cause and gladly offer their lives seeking His pleasure. ip: pi& AfpMU <i%} iAnd Allah likes not the wrongdoers. And that Allah may test those who believe} [3:140,141], by forgiving them their sins if they have any. Otherwise, Allah will raise their grades according to the losses they suffered. Allah's statement, iand destroy the disbelievers}, for it is their conduct that if they gain the upper hand, they transgress and commit aggression.

However, this conduct only leads to ultimate destruction, extermination, perishing and dying out. Allah then said, Oj ijU- Si 4Do you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who will perform Jihad and (also) knows (tests) those ivho are the patient?) [3:142]. The Ayah asks, do you think that you will enter Paradise without being tested with warfare and hardships? Allah said in Surat Al-Baqarah, itlb' f-f—* (££ Oi 'jU-i fty 40r think you that you ivill enter Paradise without such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and ivere so shaken... [2:214]. Allah said. 4Alif Lam Mim . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested?) [29:1,2], This is why He said here, 4D0 you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah knows (tests) those of you who will perform Jihad and (also) knows (tests) those who are the patient?) [3:142] meaning, you will not earn Paradise

until you are tested and thus Allah knows who among you are the ones who struggle and fight in His cause and are patient in the face of the enemy. Allah said, 4 fb iYou did indeed wish for death (martyrdom) before you met it. Now you have seen it openly luith your own eyes) [3:143]. The Ayah proclaims, O believers! Before today, you wished

that you could meet the enemy and were eager to fight them. What you wished has occurred, so fight them and be patient. In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah % said, Si 1^1413 ^buji it tjLj iZ) \££ v» «Do not toish to encounter the enemy, and ask Allah for your loell-being. However, if you do encounter them, then observe patience and know that Paradise is under the shade of swords . »' 11 This is why Allah said here, }Noiu you have seen it}: death, you saw it when the swords appeared, the blades were sharpened, the spears crisscrossed and men stood in lines for battle. This part of the Ayah contains a figure of speech that mentions imagining what can be felt but not seen. jjt jXiii' f\ ,iii5 jjul j* cjii. ji jjLj yi &j} lij «5lf Itii 111 jli c. d* |>*J V*3 *£i'y ijjl' *- J_ . • r*\ J*' Cjitj. Ofoi ji UW , 4-*4 j; Jj'?—J 4% L*j j 4ji'j i [yu^» Uj «if 4 jr^Lal Q *jaf# gcsi ^3 e/ -4 £# u £3 ij* j vS \$\$ i:*Kjc u% & C?5it 4,\$& 4144. Muhammad is no more tlum a Messenger, and indeed Messengers have passed away before him. Ifhe dies or is killed, will you then turn back on your heels? And he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allah; and Allah will reward the grateful.} 4145. And no person can ever die except by Allah's leave and at an appointed term. And whoever desires a reward in the 111 Fath Al-Bari 6:181, Muslim 3 : 1362

280 Tafoir Ibn Kathir world, We shall give him of it; and whoever desires a reward in the Hereafter, We shall give him thereof. And We shall reward the grateful 4146. And many a Prophet fought and along with him many Ribbiyyun . But they never lost heart for that which befall them in Allah's way, nor did nor they weaken nor degrade themselves. And Allah loves the patient.} 4147. And they said nothing but: "Our Lord! Forgive us our sins and our transgressions, establish our feet firmly, and give us victory over the disbelievingfolk."} 4148. So Allah gave them the reward of this world, and the excellent reward of the Hereafter. And Allah loves the good- doers.} The Rumor that the Prophet^ was Killed atUhud When Muslims suffered defeat in battle at Uhud and some of them were killed, Shaytan shouted, "Muhammad has been killed." Ibn Qami'ah went back to the idolators and claimed, "I have killed Muhammad." Some Muslims believed this rumor and thought that the Messenger of Allah had been killed, claiming that this could happen, for Allah narrated that this occurred to many Prophets before. Therefore, the Muslims' resolve was weakened and they did not actively participate in battle. This is why Allah sent down to His Messenger His statement, 4Muhammad is no more titan a Messenger, and indeed Messengers have passed away before him.} he is to deliver All&h's Message and may be killed in the process, just as what happened to many Prophets before. Ibn Abi Najlh said that his father said that a man from the Muhajinn passed by an Ansari man who was bleeding (during Uhud) and said to him, "O fellow! Did you know that Muhammad was killed?" The Ansari man said, "Even if Muhammad was killed, he has indeed conveyed the Message. Therefore, defend your religion." The Ayah, 4&fi£ *1 &&

iMuhammad is tto more than a Messenger, and indeed (many) Messengers have passed away before him}, was revealed. This story was collected by Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi in Dala'il An-NubuwwahJ Allah said next, while chastising those who became weak, jje. jt OLS y iff he dies or is

killed, will you then turn back on your heels?}, become disbelievers, iAnd he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allah; and Allah will give reward to those who are grateful}, those who obeyed Allah, defended His religion and followed His Messenger jg whether he was alive or dead. The Sahih, Musnad and Sunan collections gathered various chains of narration stating that Abu Bakr recited this Ayah when the Messenger of Allah died. Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah said that Abu Bakr came riding his horse from his dwelling in As-Sunh. He dismounted, entered the Masjid and did not speak to anyone until he came to her (in her room) and went directly to the Prophet, who was covered with a marked blanket. Abu Bala- uncovered his face, knelt down and kissed him, then started weeping and proclaimed, “My father and my mother be sacrificed for you! Allah will not combine two deaths on you. You have died the death, which was written for you.” Ibn ‘Abbas narrated that Abu Bakr then came out, while TJmar was addressing the people, and Abu Bakr told him to sit down but TJmar refused, and the people attended to Abu Bakr and left TJmar. Abu Bakr said, “To proceed; whoever among you worshipped Muhammad, then Muhammad is dead, but whoever worshipped Allah, Allah is alive and will never die. Allah said, | 1) Dald’ilAn-Nubuwwah 3 :248 . This is a Mursal narration

282 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr iMuhammad is no more than a Messenger and indeed (many) Messengers have passed away before him . Ifhe dies or is killed, will you then turn back on your heels? And he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allah ; and Allah will reward the grateful.}” The narrator added, “By Allah, it was as if the people never knew that Allah had revealed this verse before until Abu Bakr recited it, and then whoever heard it, started reciting it.” Said bin Al-Musayyib said that TJmar said, “By Allah! When I heard Abu Bakr recite this Ayah, my feet could not hold me, and I fell to the ground.” Allah said, C>% ^1 OjËi cÿf iAnd no person can ever die except by Allah's leave and at an appointed term.} [3:145] meaning, no one dies except by Allah’s decision, after he has finished the term that Allah has destined for him. This is why Allah said. iat an appointed term} which is similar to His statements, 4^1 iAnd no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but it is in a Book} [35:1 1], and, 'Jj3 4' 4He it is W?!o has created you from clay, and then has decreed a (stated) term (for you to die) . And there is with Him another determined term (for you to be resurrected)} [6:2]. This Ayah [3:145] encourages cowards to participate in battle; for doing so, or avoiding battle neither decreases, nor increases the life term. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that, Habib bin Suhban said that a Muslim man, Hujr bin ‘Adi, said in a battle, “What prevents you from crossing this river (the Euphrates) to the enemy? 111 FathAl-Bari 7 :751 .

J jt£=» Uj^ iAnd no person can ever die except by Allah's leave and at an appointed term\$>?” He then crossed the river riding his horse, and when he did, the Muslims followed him. When the enemy saw them, they started shouting, “Diwan (Persian; crazy),” and they ran away. Allah said next. / 1^, m *) // t/, # xÿi y-* V-M 4And whoever desires a reioard in the world, We shall give him of it; and whoever desires a reward in the Hereafter, We shall give him thereof Therefore, the Ayah proclaims, whoever works for the sake of this life, will only earn what Allah decides he will earn. However, he will not have a share in the Hereafter. Whoever works for the sake of the Hereafter, Allah will give him a share in the Hereafter, along with what He decides for him in this life. In similar statements, Allah said, c* c#f 14&& te* a 4 & 24 & iWhosoever desires (by his deeds) the reward of the Hereafter, We give him increase in his reward, and whosoever desires the reivard of this world (by his deeds), We give him thereof (what is decreed for him), and he has no portion in the Hereafter. [42:20], and, W’Uq Y 4 n- 1*1

uul*- jS iCj u Cfj yj uiij. of" *>' ri-t.p » I-'-' " •< >-4;»- ,>>* _>*> L* J *^2 4W7iom.'r desires the quick-passing (transitory enjoyment of this world). We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have appointed for him Hell; he will 111 IbnAbiHStim 2:584.

bum therein disgraced and despised. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer, then such are the ones whose striving shall be appreciated} [17:18-19]. In this Ayah [3:145], Allah said, 4And We shall reward the grateful.} meaning. We shall award them with Our favor and mercy in this life and the Hereafter, according to the degree of their appreciation [of Allah] and their good deeds. Allah then comforts the believers because of what they suffered in Uhud, *-9\$,*-« yH Crt iAnd many a Prophet fought and along with him many Ribbiyyiin. } It was said that this Ayah means that many Prophets and their companions were killed in earlier times, as is the view chosen by Ibn Jarir. It was also said that the Ayah means that many Prophets witnessed their companions' death before their eyes. However, Ibn Ishaq mentioned another explanation in his Strah, saying that this Ayah means, "Many a Prophet was killed, and he had many companions whose resolve did not weaken after their Prophet died, and they did not become feeble in the face of the enemy. What they suffered in Jihad in Allah's cause and for the sake of their religion did not make them lose heart. This is patience, iand Allah loves the patient.}" As-Suhayli agreed with this explanation and defended it vigorously. This view is supported by Allah saying; sfa LZ} 4And along with him many Ribbiy](iin}. In his book about the battles, Al-Amawi mentioned only this explanation for the Ayah. Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that, Ibn Mas'ud said that,

imany Ribbiyyun} means, thousands. 111 Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Sa'id bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabi' and 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said that the word Ribbiyyun means, large bands'. [2] 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mmar said that Al-Hasan said that, imany Ribbiyyun} means, many scholars. He also said that it means patient and pious scholars. Uj ijui* <iit 4 iPut they never lost heart for that which befell them in Allah's way, nor did they weaken nor degrade themselves. } Qatadah and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said that, iJdS> Cj} inor did they weaken}, means, after their Prophet was killed. inor degrade themselves}, by reverting from the true guidance and religion. Rather, they fought on the path that Allah's Prophet fought on until they met Allah. Ibn Abbas said that, iij,&LL\ inor degrade themselves^ means, nor became humiliated, while As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said that it means, they did not give in to the enemy. o, cSt 44 <A«d AHafc loves the patient. And they said nothing but: "Our Lord! Forgive us our sins and our transgressions, establish our feet firmly, and give us victory over the disbelieving folk/> 111 At-Tabari 7 :266 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :587-588 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :591

[3:146-147], and this was the statement that they kept repeating. Therefore, 4ulit iSo Allah gave them the reward of this world} victory, triumph and the good end, 4ie\$' '-f'y iand the excellent reioard of the Hereafter} added to the gains in this life, iAtid Allah loves the good-doers}. t&X. £\$£\$> >A44 ol 4 off- — 4 J_a4 [4 C 4L i>£==rii lij .AjiLj dl-c-j *i' p4a > i~C -d)j jtt!' t* (^>5*' t 4-1 Li -r-^* 4 r^y^j ji_5 i_J> ji p£=li;4 t2)ji i>* p-^ 'Jj 4* 4-ii ji iilfj tit AjJj ij.j-3 y^4^ B. ^>1 "4 _J^(^ & 4 yf.oj » »~ tlj » iifj p *-a t» "Vj fr-sxjX* t* jt 4249. 0 yow u)/io believe! If you obey those who disbelieve, they will send you back on your heels, and you will turn back as losers.}

il50. Nay, Allah is your protector, and He is the best of helpers.} 4157. We shall cast terror into the hearts of those who disbelieve, because they joined others in worship with Allah, for which He sent no authority; their abode will be the Fire and how evil is the abode of the wrongdoers.> 4152. And Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you when you were killing them (your enemy) with His permission; until Fashiltum and fell to disputing about the order, and disobeyed after He showed you what you love. Among you are some that desire this world and some that desire the Hereafter. Then He made you flee from them, that He might test you. But surely, He forgave you, and Allah is Most Gracious to the believers. il53. (And remember) when you ran away without even casting a side glance at anyone, and the Messenger was in your rear calling you back. There did Allah give you one distress after another by way of requital, to teach you not to grieve for that which had escaped you, nor for what struck you. And Allah is Well-Aware of all that you do.} The Prohibition of Obeying the Disbelievers; the Cause of Defeat at Uhud Allah warns His believing servants against obeying the disbelievers and hypocrites, because such obedience leads to utter destruction in this life and the Hereafter. This is why Allah said, if you obey those who disbelieve, they will send you back on your heels, and you will turn back (from faith) as losers [3:149]. Allah also commands the believers to obey Him, take Him as their protector, seek His aid and trust in Him. Allah said, ^ J*- _>*) ill 4Mo/, Allah is your protector, and He is the best of helpers Allah next conveys the good news that He will put fear in the hearts of the Muslims, and feelings of subordination to the Muslims in the

hearts of their disbelieving enemies, because of their Kufr and Shirk. And Allah has prepared torment and punishment for them in the Hereafter. Allah said, p Mi 4 iWe shall cast terror into the hearts of those who disbelieve, because they joined others in worship with Allah, for which He sent no authority; their abode will be the Fire and how evil is the abode of the wrongdoers}. In addition, the Two Sahih recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah said, l oa Oj*At I *L—iN 1 jS-\\ I ^ C.-Lp .apU-Lh o.Lp?J '.LhJLa oJL>-j «oU ^ilii .ILJj Liu- w)i J! ,yji 01*3 «/ was given five things that no other Prophet before me was given. 1 was aided with fear the distance of one month, the earth was made a Masjid and clean place for me, I was allowed war booty, I was given the Intercession, and Prophets used to be sent to their people, but I was sent to all mankind particularlyV 1 ’ Allah said, 4t«jLpj ill' |ii==oi£ J^Sij} iAttd Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you} [3:152], in the beginning of the day of Uhud, iwhen you were killing them}, slaying your enemies, 44:*> iwith His permission}, for He allowed you to do that against them, mi Fath Al-Bari 1 :519 , Muslim 1 :370.

289Surah 3 . Al ‘Imran (Part-4) until when you Fashiltum}. Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Fashiltum means, lost courage’. iand fell to disputing about the order, and disobeyed such as the mistake made by the archers, iafter He showed you what you love}, that is, victory over the disbelievers, iAmong you are some that desire this world referring to those who sought to collect the booty when they saw the enemy being defeated, iand some that desire the Hereafter. Then He made you flee from them, that He might test you}. This Ayah means, Allah gave them the upper hand to try and test you, O believers, dt X&}} ibut surely, He forgave you}. He forgave the error you committed, because, and Allah knows best, the idolators were many and well supplied, while Muslims had few men and few supplies. Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara’ said, “We met the idolators on that day (Uhud) and the Prophet appointed ‘Abdullah bin Jubayr as the commander of the archers. He instructed them, ‘Retain your position, and if you see that we have defeated them, do not abandon your positions. If you

see that they defeated us, do not rush to help us.’ The disbelievers gave flight when we met them, and we saw their women fleeing up the mountain while lifting up their clothes revealing their anklets and their legs. So, the companions (of ‘Abdullah bin Jubayr) said, The booty, the booty!’ ‘Abdullah bin Jubayr said, ‘Allah’s m At-Tabari 7:291.

Messenger jg commanded me not to allow you to abandon your position.’ They refused to listen, and when they left their position, Muslims were defeated and seventy of them were killed. Abu Sufyan shouted, Is Muhammad present among these people?’ The Prophet jg said, ‘Do not answer him.’ Then he asked, Is the son of Abu Quhafah (Abu Bakr) present among these people?’ The Prophet jg said, “Do not answer him.’ He asked again. Is the son of Al-Khattab (‘Umar) present among these people? As for these (men), they have been killed, for had they been alive, they would have answered me.’ ‘Umar could not control himself and said (to Abu Sufyan), *You lie, O enemy of Allah! The cause of your misery is still present.’ Abu Sufyan said, ‘O Hubal, be high!’ On that the Prophet sg said (to his Companions), ‘Answer him back.’ They said, What shall we say?’ He said, ‘Say, Allah is Higher and more Sublime.’ Abu Sufyan said, We have the (idol) Al-*Uzza, and you have no ‘Uzza. ’ The Prophet jg said, ‘Answer him back.’ They asked, What shall we say?’ He said, ‘Say, Allah is our protector and you have no protector.’ Abu Sufyan said, ‘Our victory today is vengeance for yours in the battle of Badr, and in war (the victory) is always undecided and is shared in turns by the belligerents. You will find some of your killed men mutilated, but I did not urge my men to do so, yet I do not feel sorry for their deed.”’ Only Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith using this chain of narration.’ Muhammad bin Ishaq said that, ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr narrated that Az-Zubayr bin Al-‘Awwam said, “By Allah! I saw the female servants and female companions of Hind (Abu Sufyan’s wife) when they uncovered their legs and gave flight. At that time, there was no big or small effort separating us from capturing them. However, the archers went down the mount when the enemy gave flight from the battlefield, seeking to collect the booty. They uncovered our back lines to the horsemen of the disbelievers, who took the chance and attacked us from behind. Then a person shouted, ‘Muhammad has been killed.’ So we pulled back, and the disbelievers followed us, after we had killed those who carried their flag, and none of them dared to come close the flag, until then.”’ (1 > Fath Al-Bari 7 :405

Muhammad bin Ishaq said next, “The flag of the disbelievers was left on the ground until ‘Amrah bint ‘Alqamah Al- Harithiyyah picked it up and gave it to the Quraysh who held it.” Allah said, iThen He made you flee from them, that He might test you} [3:152]. Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “My uncle Anas bin An-Nadr was absent from the battle of Badr. He said, I was absent from the first battle the Prophet jfe fought (against the pagans). (By Allah) if Allah gives me a chance to fight along with the Messenger of Allah, then Allah will see how (bravely) I will fight.’ On the day of Uhud when the Muslims turned their backs and fled, he said, ‘O Allah! I apologize to You for what these (meaning the Muslims) have done, and I denounce what these pagans have done.’ Then he advanced lifting his sword, and when Sa’d bin Mu’adh met him, he said to him, ‘O Sa’d bin Mu’adh! Where are you! Paradise! I am smelling its aroma coming from before (Mount) Uhud,’ and he went forth, fought and was killed. We found more than eighty stab wounds, sword blows or arrow holes on his body, which was mutilated so badly that none except his sister could recognize him, and she could only do so by his fingers or by a mole.” This is the narration reported by Al-Bukhari, Muslim also collected a similar narration from Thabit from Anas.¹²¹ The Defeat that the Muslims Suffered During the Battle

of Uhud Allah said, i(And remember) when you (Tus'idiina) ran away dreadfully without casting even a side glance at anyone}, and Allah made the disbelievers leave you after you went up the mount, escaping your enemy. Al-Hasan and Qatadah said 111 FathAl-Bari 7:411. 121 Muslim 3:1512.

that, Tus'iduna, means, 'go up the mountain'. 4without even casting a side glance at anyone meaning, you did not glance at anyone else due to shock, fear and fright. iand the Messenger iwas in your rear calling you back}, for you left him behind you, while he was calling you to stop fleeing from the enemy and to return and fight. As-Suddi said, "When the disbelievers attacked Muslim lines during the battle of Uhud and defeated them, some Muslims ran away to Al-Madlnah, while some of them went up Mount Uhud, to a rock and stood on it. On that, the Messenger of Allah kept heralding, 'Come to me, O servants of Allah! Come to me, O servants of Allah!' Allah mentioned that the Muslims went up the Mount and that the Prophet ^ called them to come back, and said. i(And remember) when you ran away without even casting a side glance at anyone, and the Messenger was in your rear calling you back}."™ Similar was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl' and Ibn Zayd.'3 ' The Ansar and Muhajirin Defended the Messenger^ Al-Bukhari recorded that Qays bin Abi Hazim said, "I saw Talhah's hand, it was paralyzed, because he shielded the Prophet with it." meaning on the day of Uhud. 14' It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu 'Uthman An-Nahdi said, "On that day (Uhud) during which the Prophet jg fought, only Talhah bin 'Ubaydullah and Sa'd remained with the ' Ibn Abi HStim 2 :609. 121 At-Tabari 7 :301 131 At-Tabari 7:303. [4 > Fath Al-Bari 7:416.

Prophet."111 Said bin Al-Musayyib said, "I heard Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas saying, The Messenger of Allah jg gave me arrows from his quiver on the day of Uhud and said, 'Shoot, may I sacrifice my father and mother for you.'" Al-Bukhari also collected this HadithJ21 The Two Sahihs recorded that Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas said, "On the day of Uhud, I saw two men wearing white clothes, one to the right of the Prophet jg and one to his left, who were defending the Prophet fiercely. I have never seen these men before or after that day." Meaning angels Jibril and Mikal, peace be upon them. 131 Abu Al-Aswad said that, 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr said, "Ubayy bin Khalaf of Bani Jumah swore in Makkah that he would kill the Messenger of Allah sg- When the Messenger was told of his vow, he said, 'Rather, I shall kill him, Allah willing.' On the day of Uhud, Ubayy came while wearing iron shields and proclaiming, 'May I not be saved, if Muhammad is saved.' He then headed to the direction of the Messenger of Allah sg intending to kill him, but Mus'ab bin 'Umayr, from Bani Abd Ad-Dar, intercepted him and shielded the Prophet jg with his body, and Mus'ab bin 'Umayr was killed. The Messenger of Allah jgsaw Ubayy's neck exposed between the shields and helmet, stabbed him with his spear, and Ubayy fell from his horse to the ground. However, no blood spilled from his wound. His people came and carried him away while hewas moaning like an ox. They said to him, Why are you so anxious, it is only a flesh wound?' Ubayy mentioned to them the Prophet's vow, 'Rather, I shall kill Ubayy', then commented, *By He in Whose Hand is my soul! Ifwhat hitme hits the people ofDhul-Majaz (apopular pre- Islamic marketplace), theywould all have perished.'He then died andwent to the Fire, iSo, away with the dwellers of the blazing Fire!} [67:11]." This was collected by Musa bin OJqbah from Az-Zuhri from Said bin Al-MusayyibJ4 (11 Al-Bukhari no. 4060 and Muslim no. 2414. ^ Al-Bukhari no . 4055 [3] Al-Bukhari no. 4054, Muslim no. 2306. The narrations from "Urwah and Said are Mursala

It is recorded in the Two Sahih that when he was asked about the injuries the Messenger jg sustained [in Uhud], Sahl bin Sa'd said, "The face of Allah's Messenger jg was injured, his front tooth was broken and his helmet was smashed on his head. Therefore, Fatimah, the daughter of Allah's Messenger jg washed off the blood while 'Ali was pouring water on her hand. When Fatimah saw that the bleeding increased more by the water, she took a mat, burnt it, and placed the ashes in the wound of the Prophet sg and the blood stopped oozing out." Allah said next, AThere did Allah give you one distress after another} [3:153), He gave you grief over your grief. Ibn 'Abbas said, The first grief was because of the defeat, especially when it was rumored that Muhammad sg was killed. The second grief was when the idolators went up the mount and The Messenger of Allah sg said, 'O Allah! It is not for them to rise above us.'"111 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf said, "The first distress was because of the defeat and the second when a rumor started that Muhammad sg was killed, which to them, was worse than defeat." Ibn Marduwyah recorded both of these. Mujahid and Qatadah said, "The first distress was when they heard that Muhammad sg was killed and the second when they suffered casualties and injury." It has also been reported that Qatadah and Ar-RabT bin Anas said that it was the opposite [order]. As- Suddi said that the first distress was because of the victory and booty that they missed and the second because of the enemy rising above them (on the mount). Allah said, iby way of requital to teach you not to grieve for that which had escaped you}, for that you missed the booty and triumph over your enemy. inor for what struck you}, of injury and fatalities, as Ibn 'Abbas, 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi 111 This narration is not authentic.

cmm v< m» j<* pr~^ ^-hQj p\$#&G&k£ {&£ \>- -I' ' - 'H ' stated. 1 11 Allah said next, 4And Allah is Well- Aware of all that you do.} all praise is due to Him, and thanks, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, the Most High, Most Honored. !lrJ (^1* Jj* S-^tl& \L\i '£\ ?<rf l»P_ui (V,. a> JJ \$ \$\$ % & Si ^ \$ si\ h ji \-J. Jt fSj\ ' ,{ ti . ' ->:» ' i V U (Vt—o' -J by^r. ft Q 3? i> 3)£ 25 5j£ /j\ S> 4 £ is jt jss si' S3 a i jllf 'jly v>'ij S 1* S“?^> 4#2X & t\ fa i3 i3S t^r d^ d> *> >/ >> . "it<^f'i""if'l- J;, / >>ri <'A^> jtt' e/ i't" <<'>>. r't **A ^ _•Jj-nl^a£lL^ A»- A.* 4Ji » d ,>->*4^1 4254. Then after the distress, He sent down security far you. Slumber overtook a party of you, while another party was thinking about themselves and thought wrongly of Allah - the thought of ignorance. They said, "Have we any part in the affair?" Say: "Indeed the affair belongs wholly to Allah." They hide within themselves what they dare not reveal to you, saying : "If we had anything to do with the affair, none of us IbnAbiHatim 2:613.

would have been killed here." Say: "Even ifyou had remained in your homes, those for zvhorn death was decreed would certainly have gone forth to the place of their death," but that Allah might test what is in your breasts; and to purify that which was in your hearts (sins), and Allah is All-Knower of zohat is in the breasts 4155. Tlwse of you who turned back on the day the two hosts met, Shaytan only caused them to err because of sotne of ivhat they had earned. But Allah, indeed, has forgiven them. Surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing . Slumber Overcame the Believers; the Fear that the Hypocrites Suffered Allah reminds His servants of His favor when He sent down on them tranquillity and slumber that overcame them while they were carrying their weapons and feeling distress and grief. In this case, slumber is a favor and carries meanings of calmness and safety. For instance, Allah said in Surat Al-Anfal about the battle of Badr, 4(Remember) luhen He covered you with a slumber as a securityfrom Him^ [8 : 11]. A1-Bukhari recorded that Anas said that, Abu Talhah said, "I was among

those who were overcome by slumber during the battle of Uhud. My sword fell from my hand several times and I would pick it up, then it would fall and I would pick it up again.” [11 Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith in the stories of the battles without a chain of narration, and in the book of Tafsir with a chain of narrators. 121 At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Al-Hakim recorded from Anas that Abu Talhah said, “On the day of Uhud, I raised my head and looked around and found that everyone’s head was nodding from slumber.” This is the wording of At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Hasan Sahib”.³ An-Nasal also recorded this Hadith from Anas who said that Abu Talhah m FathAl-Bari 7:22. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :76, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :358 •3 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:358, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:349, Al-Hakim

said, “I was among those who were overcome by slumber.”¹ The second group mentioned in the Ayah were the hypocrites who only thought about themselves, for they are the most cowardly people and those least likely to support the truth, ^ jf- 4and thought wrongly of Allah - the thought of ignorance} [3: 154], for they are liars and people who have doubts and evil thoughts about Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. Allah said, iTiteti after the distress, He sent dmon security for you. Slumber overtook a party ofyou}, the people of faith, certainty, firmness and reliance (on Allah) who are certain that Allah shall give victory to His Messenger jfe and fulfill his objective. {While another party was thinking about themselves}, and they were not overcome by slumber because of their worry, fright and fear, iand thought wrongly ofAllah - the thought of ignorance}. Similarly, Allah said in another statement, i<4 A C& J J \$.} {Nay, but you thought that the Messenger and the believers would never return to theirfamilies} [48:12]. This group thought that the idolators achieved ultimate victory, when their forces took the upper hand in battle, and that Islam and its people would perish. This is typical of people of doubt and hesitation, in the event of a hardship, they fall into such evil thoughts. Allah then described them that, "" An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :349.

they said in this situation, 4“Have we any part in the affair?") Allah replied, jL“^S < .< ,i ti . ' >.> *4 .?> ,1 •» - .>v ojJ-. V L. |»j_All xj itA* oj, 4Say : "Indeed the affair belongs wholly to Allah." They hide within themselves what they dare not reveal to you.) Allah exposed their secrets, that is. s*, a^ 3)sjm isaying : "Ifwe had anything to do with the affair, none of us would have been killed here.") although they tried to conceal this thought from the Messenger of Allah jgj. Ibn Ishaq recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said that Az-Zubayr said, “I was with the Messenger of Allah jgg when fear intensified and Allah sent sleep to us (during the battle of Uhud). At that time, every man among us (except the hypocrites) was nodding off. By Allah! As if in a dream, I heard the words of Mu'attib bin Qushayr, If we had anything to do with the affair, none of us would have been killed here.’ I memorized these words of his, which Allah mentioned later on, 4&cget# S; cix)s;» isaying : "Ifwe had anything to do with the affair, none of us would have been killed here.)" Ibn Abi Hatim collected this Hadith.^ Allah the Exalted said, 4Say: "Even if you had remained in your homes, those for whom death was decreed would certainly have gone forth to the place of their death,") meaning, this is Allah’s appointed destiny and a decision that ill Ibn Abi Hfitim 2 :620

will certainly come to pass, and there is no escaping it. Allah’s statement, 4that Allah might test what is in your breasts; and to purify that which teas in your hearts,} means, so that He tests you with whatever befell you, to distinguish good from evil and the deeds and statements of the believers from those of the hypocrites, ^j} iand Allah is All-Knower ofwhat is in the breasts}, and what the hearts conceal. Some

of the Believers Give Flight on the Day of Uhud Allah then said, « Those of you who turned back on the day the two hosts met, Shaytan only caused them to err because of some of what they had earned » [3:155], because of some of their previous errors. Indeed, some of the Salaf said, “The reward of the good deed includes being directed to another good deed that follows it, while the retribution of sin includes committing another sin that follows it.” Allah then said, but Allah, indeed, has forgiven them, their giving flight, surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing. He forgives sins, pardons and exonerates His creatures. Imam Ahmad recorded that Shaqiq said, “ ‘Abdur-Rahman bin ‘Awf met Al-Walid bin Tqibah, who said to him, Why did you desert ‘Uthman, the Leader of the Faithful?’ ‘Abdur-Rahman said, Tell him that I did not run away during Uhud, remain behind during Badr, nor abandon the Sunnah of ‘Umar.’ Al-Walid told ‘Uthman what ‘Abdur-Rahman said. ‘Uthman

iso that Allah may make it a cause of regret in their hearts.} means, Allah creates this evil thought in their hearts so that their sadness and the grief they feel for their loss would increase. Allah refuted them by saying, 'fit- &*¥ ilt is Allah that gives life and causes death. for the creation is under Allah's power, and the decision is His Alone. No one lives or dies except by Allah's leave, and no one's life is increased or decreased except by His decree. 4XJ o£JSC iAnd Allah is All-Seer ofwhat you do,} for His knowledge and vision encompasses all His creation and none of their affairs ever escapes Him. Allah's statement, ri^ jy*- au* ot j' Sir** j CJ^JT iAnd ifyou are killed or die in theway ofAllah, forgiveness and mercyfromAllah arefarbetter than all that theyamass.} [3 : 157), indicating that death and martyrdom in Allah's cause Eire a means of earning Allah's mercy, forgiveness Eind pleasure. This, indeed, is better than remaining in this life with its short lived delights. Furthermore, whoever dies or is killed will return to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, and He will reward him if he has done good deeds, or will punish him for his evil deeds. Allah sEud, iAnd whether you die or are killed, verily, unto Allah you shall be gathered.} [3 :158). fr* Oj oiSll l£i cJZ jjj \\l} i>[44 it k ^ pjp.j p. j & fc £ <2 P%, Ob'p C& * it fe f ff. <3^ 4*^ Jiii 0^ ^3 Uj JjfyP i*t oj i>S' oy<y gjjt i>*it 'J pj \\5 ^_aj ^i==

JiJ Cj %>j Zi\ JuP i->y> (U Jij ^ ijs £ 1# hi& H ® ^L\$» ujJ 33 os ly^" *Ij 4159. And by (be mercy of A//db, you dea/f with them gently. And had you been severe and harsh-hearted, they would have broken away from about you; so pardon them, and ask forgiveness for them ; and consult them in the affairs. Then when you have taken a decision, put your trust in Allah, certainly, Allah loves those who put their trust (in Him).} 4160. If Allah helps you, none can overcome you; and if He forsakes you, who is there after Him that can help you? And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust.} 4161 . It is not for any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, and whosoever deceives his companions over the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took. Then every person shall be paid in full what he has earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustly.} 4162. Is then one who follows (seeks) the pleasure of Allah like the one who draws on himself the wrath of Allah? His abode is Hell, and worse indeed is that destination!} 4163. They are in varying grades with Allah, and Allah is All- Seer of what they do.} 4164. Indeed, Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messenger from among themselves, reciting unto them His verses (the Qur'an), and purifying them, and instructing them (in) the Book (the Qur'an) and Al-Hikmah [the wisdom and the Sunrtah], while before that they had been in manifest error.} Among the Qualities of Our Prophet Muhammad^ are Mercy and Kindness Allah addresses His Messenger and reminds him and the believers of the favor that He has made his heart and words soft for his Ummah, those who follow his command and refrain from what he prohibits.

iAnd by the mercy of AlWt, you dealt with them gently} [3:159], meaning, who would have made you this kind, if it was not Allah's mercy for you and them. Qatadah said that, J £4\$ '<i Cfr iAnd by the mercy of Allah, you dealt with them gently} means, "With Allah's mercy you became this kind." Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that this, indeed, is the description of the behavior that Allah sent Muhammad gg with. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, i ' —Ou iVerily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is anxious over you (to be rightly guided, to repent to Allah); for the believers (he is) full of pity, kind, and merciful^ [9:128]. Allah said next, i'£ j. ijliV JSi di y)} iAnd had you been severe and harsh-hearted, they would have broken away from about you;} The severe person is he who utters harsh words, and, iharsh-hearted} is the person whose heart is hard. Had this been the Prophet's behavior, "They would have scattered from around you. However, Allah gathered them and made you kind and soft with them, so that their hearts congregate around you." 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that he read the description of the Messenger of Allah £§ in previous Books, "He is not severe, harsh, obscene in the marketplace or dealing evil for evil. Rather, he forgives and pardons. The Order for Consultation and to Abide by it Allah said, (i| Path Al-Bari 8 :449

4 (&4&J p> 4So pardon them, and ask (Allah's) forgiveness for them; and consult them in the affairs.} The Messenger of Allah used to ask his Companions for advice about various matters, to comfort their hearts, and so they actively implement the decision they reach. For instance, before the battle of Badr, the Prophet ^ asked his Companions for if Muslims should intercept the caravan (led by Abu Sufyan). They said, "O Messenger of Allah! If you wish to cross the sea, we would follow you in it, and if you march forth to Barkul-Ghimad we would march with you. We would never say what the Children of Israel said to Musa, 'So go, you and your Lord, and fight you two, we are sitting right here.' Rather, we say march forth and we shall march forth with you; and before you, and to your right and left shall we

fight.” The Prophet ﷺ also asked them for their opinion about where they should set up camp at Badr. Al-Mundhir bin ‘Amr suggested to camp close to the enemy, for he wished to acquire martyrdom. Concerning the battle of Uhud, the Messenger ﷺ asked the Companions if they should fortify themselves in Al-Madinah or go out to meet the enemy, and the majority of them requested that they go out to meet the enemy, and he did. He also took their advice on the day of Khandaq (the Trench) about conducting a peace treaty with some of the tribes of Al-Ahzab (the Confederates), in return for giving them one-third of the fruits of Al-Madinah. However, Sa’d bin Tjbadah and Sa’d bin Mu’adh rejected this offer and the Prophet ﷺ went ahead with their advice. The Prophet ﷺ also asked them if they should attack the idolaters on the Day of Hudaibiyyah, and Abu Bakr disagreed, saying, “We did not come here to fight anyone. Rather, we came to perform Umrah.” The Prophet ﷺ agreed. On the day of Ifk, (i.e. the false accusation), the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said to them, “O Muslims! Give me your advice about some men who falsely accused my wife (‘A’ishah). By Allah! I never knew of any evil to come from my wife. And they accused whom? They accused her from whom I only knew righteous conduct, by Allah!” The Prophet ﷺ asked ‘Ali and Usamah about divorcing ‘A’ishah. In summary, the Prophet ﷺ used to take his Companions’ advice for battles and other important events.

Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet ﷺ said; *The one whom advice is sought from is to be entrusted» This was recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasai who graded it tafdscm. Trust in Allah After Taking the Decision Allah’s statement, 4\$ jp X^P iThenwhenyou have taken a decision,putyour trust inAllah, means, ifyou conduct the required consultation and you then make a decision, trust in Allah over your decision, iu&XUM l\} icertainly, Allah loves those who put their trust (in Him)}. Allah’s statement, pi’ jpj f&A. pfjfr b O-J OjJ Ofc- pi’ p&i <m& ilfAllah helps you, none can overcome you; and ifHeforsakes you, who is there after Him that can help you? And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust}, is similar to His statement that we mentioned earlier, 4*\$^ jff JI <ii x* Cf} 4And there is no victory except from Allah the Almighty, the All-Wise} [3:126]. Allah next commands the believers to trust in Him, 4*&\$ &&} 4And in Allah (Alone) let believers put their trust}. Treachery with the Spoils of War was not a Trait of the Prophet^ Allah said, Abu Dawud 5 :345 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :109

43^ o’ iff,& ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that the Ayah means, “It is not for a Prophet to breach the trust.” * Ibn Jarir recorded that, Ibn ‘Abbas said that, this Ayah, j* Iff,& ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the bootyfa was revealed in connection with a red robe that was missing from the spoils of war of Badr. Some people said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ might have taken it. When this rumor circulated, Allah sent down, 4^*4^ fy. I>*J 0* Iff, ilt is not far any Prophet to illegally take a part of the booty, and whosoever is deceitful with the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he tookfa *2 ’ This was also recorded by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who said “Hasan Gharib ”.*3 * This Ayah exonerates the Messenger of Allah ﷺ of all types of deceit and treachery, be it returning what was entrusted with him, dividing the spoils of war, etc. Allah then said, iand whosoever is deceitful with the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took. Then every person shall be paid in full what he has earned, and they shall not be dealt with unjustlyfa This Ayah contains a stern warning and threat against Ghulul [stealing from the booty], and there are also Hadiths, that prohibit

such practice. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Malik Al-Ashja'i said that the Prophet said, "أشبهت الغلول بـأرض من أرض الله" (The worst Ghulul (i.e. stealing) with Allah is a yard of land, that is, when you find 'wo neighbors in a land or home and one of them illegally acquires a yard of his neighbor's land. When he does, he will be tied with it from the seven earths until the Day of Resurrection.) [11 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Humayd As-Saldi said, "The Prophet appointed a man from the tribe of Al-Azd, called Ibn Al-Lutbiyyah, to collect the Zakah. When he returned he said, 'This (portion) is for you and this has been given to me as a gift.' The Prophet stood on the Minbar and said, (أشبهت الغلول بـأرض من أرض الله) [12 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Humayd said, "I have seen him with my eyes and heard him with my ears, and ask Zayd bin Thabit." This is recorded in the Two Sahihs [13 In the book of Ahkam of his Sunan, Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi [14 * Ahmad 4 :140. [15 * Ahmad 5:423, Al-Bukhari no. 2597,7174, Muslim no. 1832.

recorded that Mu'adh bin Jabal said, "The Messenger of Allah sent me to Yemen, but when I started on the journey, he sent for me to come back and said, «Do you know why I summoned you back? Do not take anything without my permission, for if you do, it will be Ghulul. And whosoever deceives his companions over the booty, he shall bring forth on the Day of Resurrection that which he took». This is why I summoned you, so now go and fulfill your mission. At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan Gharib." In addition, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Prophet got up among us and mentioned Ghulul and emphasized its magnitude. He then said, «أشبهت الغلول بـأرض من أرض الله» [16 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Humayd said, "I have seen him with my eyes and heard him with my ears, and ask Zayd bin Thabit." This is recorded in the Two Sahihs [17 In the book of Ahkam of his Sunan, Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi [18 * Ahmad 4 :140. [19 * Ahmad 5:423, Al-Bukhari no. 2597,7174, Muslim no. 1832.

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flurah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-41 311 4/s then one who follows (seeks) the pleasure of Allah like the one who draws on himself the wrath of Allah? His abode is Hell, and worse indeed is that destination!) [3:162], This refers to those seeking what pleases Allah by obeying His legislation, thus earning His pleasure and tremendous rewards, while being saved from His severe torment. This type of person is not similar to one who earns Allah's anger, has no means of escaping it and who will reside in Jahannam on the Day of Resurrection, and what an evil destination it is. There are many similar statements in the Qur'an, such as, «أشبهت الغلول بـأرض من أرض الله» [24 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Humayd said, "I have seen him with my eyes and heard him with my ears, and ask Zayd bin Thabit." This is recorded in the Two Sahihs [25 In the book of Ahkam of his Sunan, Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi [26 * Ahmad 4 :140. [27 * Ahmad 5:423, Al-Bukhari no. 2597,7174, Muslim no. 1832.

been revealed unto you (O Multammad jg)from your Lord is the truth be like him who is blind?} [13:19], and, 4C% g £ (££ Cij ieMj £\} 41s he whom We have promised an excellent promise (Paradise) which he will find true, like him whom We have made to enjoy the luxuries of the life of (this) world?} [28:61]. Allah then said, iTliey are in varying grades with Allah,} [3:163] meaning, the people of righteousness and the people of evil are in grades, as Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Muhammad bin Ishaq said. Abu TJBaydah and Al-Kisa'i said that this Ayah refers to degrees, meaning there are various degrees and dwellings in Paradise, as well as, various degrees and dwellings in the Fire. In another Ayah, Allah said, 4For all there will be degrees (or ranks) according to what they did} [6:132]. Next, Allah said, I 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 2 :646, At-Tabari 7 :367.

and Allah is All-Seer ofwhat they do}, and He will compensate or punish them, and will never rid them of a good deed, or increase their evil deeds. Rather, each will be treated according to his deeds. The Magnificent Blessing in the Advent ofOur Prophet Muhammadi Allah the Most High said: 4^ if (ip* S[Of If !&} 4Indeed Allah conferred a great favor on the believers when He sent among them a Messengerfrom among themselves,\$ Meaning, from their own kind, so that it is possible for them to speak with him, ask him questions, associate with him, and benefit from him. Just as Allah said: 4^1 \y&l if£ J 4And among His signs is that he created for them mates, that they mayfind rest in Meaning; of their own kind. And Allah said; <%»3 ta5& Pi% a n. \$ iSay "I am only a man like you . It fws been revealed to me that your God is One God"} [18:1 10). 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets [25:20). P is ^n 4And We sent not before you any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people oftownships} [12:109], and, 40 you assembly of Jinn and mankind! "Did not there come to you Messengersfrom among you . ..?"} [6: 130). Allah's favor is perfected when His Messenger to the people

-• \>v VT sm -* 1 . I t & AlA, . * ^-' c "- "it. .t > * "'is S.Z " •* i*' ,-'*!• If ^I^oyj'os— is from their own kind, so that they are able to talk to him and inquire about the meanings of Allah's Word. This is why Allah said, 4*^» n?*- 4reciting unto them His verses [3:164], the Qur'an, iatid purifying them}, commanding them to do righteous works and forbidding them from committing evil. This is how their hearts will be purified and cleansed of the sin and evil that used to fill them when they were disbelievers and ignorant. imt&& iand instructing them (in) the Book and the Hikmah,} the Qur'an and the Sunnah, 4d3 oi iwhile before that they had been}, before sending this Prophet, Muhammad jfe, ji} tin manifest error.} indulging in plain and unequivocal error and ignorance that are clear to everyone. f f i */r 4»\ O' ^CJu' X* j; yk j» \$ j£i» tf&i (TVX^ j» tiJ

<3\i!ss2i' Jdt ^ & & ^Li fi£i j) (j!li \yZi\ jl J} ijbi ^ 3-*j iy&T ji£lj rn-^ 4 o-\$ ^ rt?A JHt rri >^=4 r if j» ij tj Li LjpLLI 3) cr^vlt *)S j\$ W5jlis2 Lt pjbt ilfj 4 ^~S"" 0>Jt |*£»ujil <165. (W7wf is the matter with you?) When a single disaster smites you, although you smote (your enemies) with one twice as great, you say: "From where does this come to us?" Say, "It isfrom yourselves."And Allah has power over all things.} <166. And what you suffered on the day the two armies met, was by the leave of Allah, in order that He might test the believers <167. And that He might test the hypocrites, it was said to them : "Come, fight in the way ofAlldh or defend yourselves." They said: "Had we knoion that fighting will take place, we would certainly havefollowed you." They were that day, nearer to disbelief than to faith, saying with their mouths what was not in their hearts. And Alldh has full knowledge ofwhat they

conceal. ^ <368. (They are) the ones who said about their killed brethren while they themselves sat (at home) : "If only they had listened to us, they would not have been killed." Say: "Avert death from your own selves, if you speak the truth."}

The Reason and Wisdom Behind the Defeat at Uhud

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1011–1062]

Allah said, *When a single disaster smites you*, in reference to when the Muslims suffered seventy fatalities during the battle of Uhud, *although you smote (your enemies) with one twice as great*, during Badr, when the Muslims killed seventy Mushriks and captured seventy others,

you say: "From where does this come to us?" why did this defeat happen to us? *It is from yourselves.*"} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that "Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "When Uhud occurred, a year after Badr, Muslims were punished for taking ransom from the disbelievers at Badr [in return for releasing the Mushriks whom they captured in that battle]. Thus, they suffered the loss of seventy fatalities and the Companions of the Messenger of Allah gave flight and abandoned him. The Messenger suffered a broken tooth, the helmet was smashed on his head and blood flowed onto his face. Allah then revealed, *When a single disaster smites you, although you smote (your enemies) with one twice as great, you say: "From where does this come to us?" Say, "It is from yourselves".* because you took the ransom." Furthermore, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Jurayj, Ar-Rab' bin Anas and As-Suddi said that the Ayah, *It is from yourselves* means, because you, the archers, disobeyed the Messenger's command to not abandon your positions. *And Allah has power over all things. and He does what He wills and decides what He wills, and there is none who can resist His decision.* Allah then said, *And what you suffered on the day the two armies met, was by the leave of Allah*, for when you ran away from your enemy, who killed many of you and injured many others, all this occurred by Allah's will

Tafsir Ibn Kathir and decree out of His perfect wisdom, in order that He might test the believers.} who were patient, firm and were not shaken, (And that He might test the hypocrites, it was said to them "Come, fight in the way of Allah or defend yourselves." They said: "Had we known that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you.") [3:167], This refers to the Companions of 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul who went back (to Al-Madinah) with him before the battle. Some believers followed them and encouraged them to come back and fight, saying, *or defend*, so that the number of Muslims increases, as Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi stated. Al-Hasan bin Salih said that this part of the Ayah means, help by supplicating for us, while others said it means, man the posts. However, they refused, saying, *"Had we known that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you."* meaning, according to Mujahid, if we knew that you would fight today, we would join you, but we think you will not fight. Allah said, *They were that day, nearer to disbelief than to faith*, This Ayah indicates that a person passes through various stages, sometimes being closer to Kufr and sometimes closer to faith, as evident by, rri

317 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) iThey were that day, nearer to disbelief than to faith,} Allah then said, isaying with their mouths what was not in their hearts .} for they utter what they do not truly believe in, such as, -fci, & 4"Had you known that fighting will take place, we would certainly have followed you."} They knew that there was an army of idolators that came from a far land raging against the Muslims, to avenge their noble men whom the Muslims killed in Badr. These idolators came in larger numbers than the Muslims, so it was clear that a battle will certainly occur. Allah said; 4And Allah has full knowledge of what they conceal.} 4(They are) the ones who said about their killed brethren while they themselves sat (at home): "If only they had listened to us, they would not have been killed."} had they listened to our advice and not gone out, they would not have met their demise. Allah said, iU £<r 4 op't 4Say: "Avert death from your own selves, if you speak the truth."} meaning, if staying at home saves one from being killed or from death, then you should not die. However death will come to you even if you were hiding in fortified castles. Therefore, fend death off of yourselves, if you are right. Mujahid said that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "This Ayah [3:168] was revealed about 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul (the chief hypocrite)." (1 iii i+UU Uj yT . (1 < At-Tabari 7:383.

318 Tafsir Ibn Kathir vr sm K , \ i 'A'-' ; ,> O i '^«LkJli 0Uh&f^oictyli-S Sii .»iDjVSJ£ ijA-A} ^Ji£J 1 cj;J 'oj,^ L3^C5/^.^CS1 jj{pj-^-j'r' (^-*» >j-£y <-»> vf j^L. ^ ^ ijiAi ^ (C* Vj jCjUe- ?i> i >lij, £rt" V <&' o'j *j> i^Uc--l C/jjl t jju J/-50 £4 £si" # 3d iS % P\$3 [>«*»' -£ J»G' aj J-O' tfts j &d A# j&Sifc pi5 % &LZ £ * r^ * <»• 'Z " (V 4U1 ^j4 4.4 4.^ ^JU iU f," .* {'•Sf JH-4 .4*"" *>— p | .» /'*/j / ry' ,1 jtfV J-*** Jj 4»1 fift)! &£*ji J&S CS1 ^ a} i>y£3 (Uyi2 Su 4vSfes0 4269. Tfrmf c mo2 o/ those as dead who are killed in the way of Allah. Nay, they are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision. 4270. They rejoice in what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounty and rejoice for the sake of those who have not yet joined them, but are left behind (not yet martyred) that on them no fear shall come, nor shall they grieve.} 4272. They rejoice in a grace and a bounty from Allah, and that Allah will not waste the reward of the believers.} 4172. Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger after being wounded; for those of them who did good deeds and feared Allah, there is a great reward.}

4173. Those to whom the people said, "Verily, the people have gathered against you, therefore, fear them." But it (only) increased them in faith, and they said : "Allah is Sufficient for us, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs."} 4174. So they returned with grace and bounty from Allah. No harm touched them; and they followed the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty. } 4175. It is only Shaytdn that suggests to you the fear of his friends; so fear them not, but fear Me, if you are indeed believers.} Virtues of the Martyrs Allah states that even though the martyrs were killed in this life, their souls are alive and receiving provisions in the Dwelling of Everlasting Life. In his Sahth, Muslim recorded that Masruq said, "We asked 'Abdullah about this Ayah, iThink not of those as dead who are killed in the way of Allah. Nay, they are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision. } He said, *We asked the Messenger of Allah jg the same question and he said, J ^ : Jlii if.'fia\ p-fcj iJjliiJl JjL JjLJ p-fc <L»J' j Jt Ooj, J t Ijli i I 01 Ijli Ull i. 0^1jA \$ <J Jy^ 'cfjd vf ULLJ- ffk jj- UiUjj-l ljSy ii*-U oTheir souls are inside green birds that have lamps, which are hanging below the Throne (of Allah), and they wander about in Paradise wherever they wish. Then they return to those lamps. Allah looks at them and says, 'Do you wish for anything?' They say, 'What more could we wish for, while we go wherever we wish in Paradise?' Allah asked them this question thrice, and when they realize that He will keep asking them until they

320 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir give an answer, they say, 'O Lord! We wish that our souls be returned to our bodies so that we are killed in Your cause again.' Allah knew that they did not have any other wish, so they were leftj *** 11 There are several other similar narrations from Anas and Abu Said. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah said, i V] lUiijI^ gry li>3—; ‘ <S»' -H l^J VjA Jij di)l - •> : f >: > ji *>)' “No soul that has a good standing with Allah and dies would wish to go back to the life of this world, except for the martyr. He would like to be returned to this life so that he could be martyred again, for he tastes the honor achieved from martyrdom . » Muslim collected this Hadith *2) In addition, Imam Ahmad recorded that, Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jtjji ij t, - UJ Jm*- *—~f\ ith ^ (jj V** bi J! ilijUj JSI5j U Oybjv : j~*~3 p-fij—' '~3o ye- «il Jlii JI yfa 'ij IjJUjJ 'itfJ illi lil "r&t- ^ : J4-3 “When your brothers were killed in Uhud, Allah placed their souls inside green birds that tend to the rivers of Paradise and eat from its fruits. They then return to golden lamps hanging in the shade of the Throne. When they tasted the delight of their food, drink and dwelling, they said, 'We wish that our brothers knew what Allah gave us so that they will not abandon Jihad or warfare.' Allah said, T will convey the neios far i/om.'» Allah revealed these and the following Ayat, a'> -r - . > . t .n£,jy j p+fj iThink not of those as dead zvho are killed in the way ofAllah. Muslim 3 : 1502. Ahmad 3:126, Muslim 1877.

Nay, they are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision. Qatadah, Ar-Rabi‘ and Ad-Dahhak said that these Ayat were revealed about the martyrs of Uhud. [2 ' Abu Bakr Ibn Marduwyah recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “The Messenger of Allah H§ looked at me one day and said, ‘O Jabir! Why do I see you sad?’ I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! My father was martyred and left behind debts and children.’ He said, t«L>-U5 Jill *j\j fj j Cr? ^ la>-f &! S U Vb JI lj\ j! ilibf : Jli .ilki-f jL. : JU» J LgJJl : Jjilt y* jS Cl : jy JU1 *. aIJj IILs JiSU Uiill «^lj y> yj fj l :Jb . jy^Tji «Should I tell you that Allah never spoke to anyone except from behind a veil? However, He spoke to your father directly. He said, 'Ask Me and I will give you.' He said, 'I ask that I am returned to life so that I am killed in Your cause again.' The Lord, Exalted He be, said, 'I have spoken the word that they shall not be returned back to it (this life).' He said, 'O Lord! Then convey the news to those 1 left behind '» Allah revealed, yt J-Jl j 'dyi- 'D i'Thmk not of those as dead who are killed in the way of Allah ... ¥’ 131 Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of AllahH said, y (H-’JJ ITjhi *** j? if if* U ((l,,t.£-j b *U>cJ I \The martyrs convene at the shore of a river close to the door of Paradise, in a green tent, where their provisions are brought to them from Paradise day and night. » ' Ahmad 1 :265. At-Taban 7:389-390. I3 ' Dala’ilAn^u^>uwwa^1 by Al-Bayhaqi 3 :299

Ahmad and Ibn Jarir collected this Hadith, which has a good chain of narration. It appears that the martyrs are of different types, some of them wander in Paradise, and some remain close to this river by the door of Paradise. It is also possible that the river is where all the souls of the martyrs convene and where they are provided with their provision day and night, and Allah knows best. Imam Ahmad narrated a Hadith that contains good news for every believer that his soul will be wandering in Paradise, as well, eating from its fruits, enjoying its delights and happiness and tasting the honor that Allah has prepared in it for him. This Hadith has a unique, authentic chain of narration that includes three of the Four Imams. Imam Ahmad narrated this Hadith from Muhammad bin Idris Ash-Shafi‘I who narrated it from Malik bin Anas Al-Asbuhi, from Az-Zuhri, from ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Ka‘b bin Malik that his father said that the Messenger of Allah sg| said, uj ^Jt ^11 «The soul of the believer becomes a bird that

feeds on the trees of Paradise, until Allah sends him back to his body when He resurrects. This Hadith states that the souls of the believers are in the shape of a bird in Paradise. As for the souls of martyrs, they are inside green birds, like the stars to the rest of the believing souls. We ask Allah the Most Generous that He makes us firm on the faith. Allah's statement, *Uj i*They rejoice in what Allah has bestowed upon them indicates that the martyrs who were killed in Allah's cause are alive with Allah, delighted because of the bounty and happiness they are enjoying. They are also awaiting their brethren, who will die in Allah's cause after them, for they will be meeting them soon. These martyrs do not have fear about Ahmad 1 :266 [at-Tabari 7 :387 131 Ahmad 3 :455

the future or sorrow for what they left behind. We ask Allah to grant us Paradise. The Two Sahih records from Anas, the story of the seventy Ansar Companions who were murdered at Bir Ma'unah in one night. In this Hadith, Anas reported that the Prophet *jg*; used to supplicate to Allah in Qunut in prayer against those who killed them. Anas said, "A part of the Qur'an was revealed about them, but was later abrogated, 'Convey to our people that we met Allah and He was pleased with us and made us pleased.'" [11 Allah said next, *i*They rejoice in a grace and a bounty from Allah, and that Allah will not waste the reward of the believers [3 :171]. Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, "They were delighted and pleased because of Allah's promise that was fulfilled for them, and for the tremendous rewards they earned." 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "This Ayah encompasses all the believers, martyrs and otherwise. Rarely does Allah mention a bounty and a reward that He granted to the Prophets, without following that with what He has granted the believers after them." The Battle of Hamra' Al-Asad Allah said, *Ls: j fk crJlfy i*Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger after being wounded [3 :172]. This occurred on the day of Hamra' Al-Asad. After the idolaters defeated the Muslims (at Uhud), they started on their way back home, but soon they were concerned because they did not finish off the Muslims in Al-Madinah, so they set out to make that battle the final one. When the Messenger of Allah got news of this, he commanded the Muslims to march to meet the disbelievers, to bring fear to their hearts and to demonstrate that the Muslims still had strength to fight. The [i] Fath Al-Bari 7 :445, Muslim 1 :468.

Prophet *jfc* only allowed those who were present during Uhud to accompany him, except for Jabir bin 'Abdullah Al-Ansari, as we will mention. The Muslims mobilized, even though they were still suffering from their injuries, in obedience to Allah and His Messenger *jfi*. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Ikrimah said, "When the idolaters returned [towards Makkah] after Uhud, they said, 'You neither killed Muhammad nor collected female captives. Woe to you for what you did. Let us go back.' When the Messenger of Allah heard this news, he mobilized the Muslim forces, and they marched until they reached Hamra Al-Asad. The idolaters said, 'Rather, we will meet next year', and the Messenger of Allah went back [to Al-Madinah], and this was considered a Ghazwah (battle). Allah sent down, *jr' IjiAj 'y t-' L jJ •*{Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger after being wounded; for those of them who did good deeds and feared Allah, there is a great reward.^ Al-Bukhari recorded that 'A'ishah said to 'Urwah about the Ayah; *i*Those who answered (the Call of) Allah and the Messenger^ "My nephew! Your fathers Az-Zubayr and Abu Bakr were among them. After the Prophet suffered the calamity at Uhud and the idolaters went back, he feared that the idolaters might try to come back and he said, 'Who would follow them?' Seventy men, including Az-Zubayr and Abu Bakr, volunteered." This was recorded by Al-Bukhari alone. ,2) As for Allah's statement, *o« J-&& JU i*Those unto whom

Ok people said, "Verily, Ok people have gathered against you, therefore, fear them." But it (only) An-Nasat in Al-Kubra no.1 1083 Al-Bukhari no. 4077.

325 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) increased them in faith} [3:173], it means, those who threatened the people, saying that the disbelievers have amassed against them, in order to instill fear in them, but this did not worry them, rather, they trusted in Allah and sought His help, and they said: "Allah is Sufficient for us, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs . " } Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, i"Allah Alone is Sufficient for us and He is the Best Disposer of affairs for us . " } "Ibrahim said it when he was thrown in fire. Muhammad said it when the people said, Verily, the people have gathered against you, therefore, fear them.' But it only increased them in faith, and they said, 'Allah is Sufficient for us and He is the Best Disposer of affairs for us.'" 1,1 Abu Bakr Ibn Marduwyah recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Prophet was told on the day of Uhud, "Verily, the people have gathered against you, therefore, fear them." Thereafter, Allah sent down this Ayah [3:173]. This is why Allah said, iSo they returned with grace and bounty from Allah. No harm touched them;} for when they relied on Allah, Allah took care of their worries. He confounded the plots of their enemies, and the Muslims returned to their land, pr—i \$ iwith grace and bounty from Allah. No harm touched them;} safe from the wicked plots of their enemies, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :77

and they followed the pleasure of Allah. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty.} Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, iSo they returned with grace and bounty from Allah,} "The 'Grace' was that they were saved. The 'Bounty' was that a caravan passed by, and those days were [Hajj] season days. Thus the Messenger of Allah & bought and sold and made a profit, which he divided between his Companions." 111 Allah then said, it is only Shaytan that suggests to you the fear of his friends,} [3:175] meaning, Shaytan threatens you with his friends and tries to pretend they are powerful and fearsome. Allah said next, 4so fear them not, but fear Me, if you are indeed believers.} meaning, "If Shaytan brings these thoughts to you, then depend on Me and seek refuge with Me. Indeed, I shall suffice you and make you prevail over them." Similarly, Allah said, it is not Allah Sufficient for His servant? Yet they try to frighten you with those besides Him!} [39:36], until, iSay: "Sufficient for me is Allah; in Him those who trust must put their trust."} [39:38]. Allah said, }So fight you against the friends of Shaytan; ever feeble indeed is the plot of Shaytan.} [4:76] and Data'll An-Nubuwwah 3:318.

>{ JLih\ 4-> ^T/ury are the party of Shaytdn. Verily, it is the party of Shaytdn that will be the losers!} [58:19), / , • - 0 ,, f ^ 4Alldh has decreed: "Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, All- Mighty .} [58:21] and 4t 4* i»' iVerily, Allah will help those who help His (cause). [22:40] and ifji 40 you who believe! If you help (in the cause of) Allah, He will help you} [47:7], and, ><r sS "*" i@h t S' i'rV . \>'s gji * pi p* pp J p-*' r& i p> iVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe, in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth. The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers. Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode.} [40:51,52] (*+• J-*-*1. j* *«' -4y_ (+12 *11' y&J' 4 Sljf i±^ . -it ijtJJ J i^Xii 51 4-&\$ 4 Uii -s*- 1*^ d*1^ wv, jLjj 4>'j jjJ ill' O'? U >\ OSfi 4*' •lij .j* « ,jn i*' y.-*" d" Si' o'? Uj i_2U' ^ tl.iX? US*^ ^ ^ 'Y5, .> *.Wg- j Ailla puki fJi (jb; In Ojijlai- ^ j; p L*i-4; all' ^ ^% <03 Aj 4176. And let not those grieve you who rush with haste to

328 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir disbelieve; verily, not the least harm will they do to Allah. It is Allah's will to give them no portion in the Hereafter. For them there is a great torment. 4177. Verily, those who purchase disbelief at the price of faith, not the least harm will they do to Allah. For them, there is a painful torment. 4178. And let not the disbelievers think that Our postponing their punishment is good for them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness. And for them is a disgraceful torment. ^ 4179. Allah will not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good. Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Unseen, but Allah chooses of His Messengers whom He wills. So believe in Allah and His Messengers. And if you believe and have Taqia of Allah, then for you there is a great reward.} 4180. And let not those who are stingy with that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be worse for them; the things that they were stingy with shall be tied to their necks like a collar on the Day of Resurrection. And Allah's is the inheritance of the heavens and the earth; and Allah is Well-Acquainted with all that you do.} Comforting the Messenger of Allah after Allah said to His Prophet, y} 4And let not those grieve you who rush with haste to disbelieve} [3:176]. Because the Prophet s.g. was eager for people's benefit, he would become sad when the disbelievers would resort to defiance, rebellion and stubbornness. Allah said, 'Do not be saddened by this behavior,' 4verily, not the least harm will they do to Allah. It is Allah's will to give them no portion in the Hereafter.} for He decided with His power and wisdom that they shall not

acquire any share in the Hereafter, \$j} iFor them there is a great torment. } Allah said about the disbelievers, iif ft 'j&& U& Vfr iVerily, those who purchase disbelief at the price of faith,} by exchanging disbelief for faith, 4&i 2J#> inot the least harm will they do to Allah.} Rather, they will only harm themselves, iU 4For them, there is a painful torment.} Allah said next, ^ Ci\ j£- ft^ J» i iAnd let not the disbelievers think tltat Our postponing their punishment is good for them. We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness. And for them is a disgraceful torment} [3:178]. This statement is similar to Allah's other statements, / v - ; +' W" \ 1 // ."<{ V X V J*. ^ (j* 0>r— 4Do they think that because We have given them abundant wealth and children, [that] We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} [23:55,56] and 4- *? V O' C-jXl J“J Ojj*} iThen leave Me Alone with such as belie this Qur'an. We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not.} [68:44], and, (*T— Qjl' j rv'fk & ^ %}

— Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAnd let not their wealth or their children amaze you. Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in this world, and tint their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers} [9:85], Allah then said, if %} 'if& a} iAllah ioill not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good.} [3:179], meaning, He allows a calamity to happen, and during this calamity His friend becomes known and His enemy exposed, the patient believer recognized and the sinful hypocrite revealed. This Ayah refers to Uhud, since Allah tested the believers in that battle, thus making known the faith, endurance, patience, firmness and obedience to Allah and His Messenger that the believers had. Allah exposed the hypocrites in their defiance, reverting from Jihad, and the treachery they committed against Allah and His Messenger jte. This is why Allah said, Jiii v& 74 iSt s? *} iAllah will not leave tlte believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good.} Mujahid commented, “He distinguished between them during

the day of Uhud.” 111 Qatadah said, “He distinguished between them in Jihad and Hijrah.” ^2| Allah said next, {J3' & Cj} 4Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Unseen.} meaning, you do not have access to Allah’s knowledge of His creation so that you can distinguish between the believer and the hypocrite, except by the signs of each type that Allah uncovers. Allah’s statement, ibut Allah chooses ofHis Messengers whom He zoills.} is similar to another Ayah, At-Tabari 7 :424 At-Tabari 7:424.

ly, JICo J^j ^3' & \ ^ IS ' j* vfs' .Y » / ~ .ijujj AjJj jy. 4(He A/o/ie is) Hie All-Knower of the Unseen, and He reveals to none His Unseen. Except to a Messenger (from mankind) lohom He has chosen, and then He makes a band of watching guards (angels) to march before him and behind him.) [72:26,271- Allah then said, jj i? \ 4So believe in Allah and His Messengers.) Obey Allah and His Messenger sfe and adhere to the law that he legislated for you, jr' 'y^b 'yj£ ofib 4and ifyou believe and fear Allah, then for you there is a great reward.) The Censure ofSelfishness, andWarning Against it Allah said, 4pi 3- 3 pi ! *- y Oi pi^1* W i-J' OS-*: 4 And let not those who are stingy zoith that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty (zuealth) think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be worsefor them.) [3:180] Therefore, the Ayah says that the miser should not think that collecting money will benefit him. Rather, it will harm him in his religion and worldly affairs. Allah mentions the money that the miser collected on the Day of Resurrection, 4)JLili)' (y_ 'jbl C ithe things that they stingy zoith shall be tied to their necks like a collar on the Day ofResurrection .) Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ag said, pj j nliLjj <1 li-bfw J Ji* jJj pii MU <3)1 »UI “iljls ui tJl'U lii -Jjjj - -

•‘Whoever Allah makes wealthy and he does not pay the Zakdh due on his wealth, then (on the Day of Resurrection) his wealth will be made in the likeness of a bald-headed poisonous male snake with two black spots over the eyes. The snake will encircle his neck and bite his cheeks and proclaim, 7 am your wealth, I am your treasure . '» The Prophet then recited the Ayah, ^ J4 j? fib*-* Oi ii' i And let not those ivho are stingy with that which Allah has bestowed on them of His bounty think that it is good for them. Nay, it will be loorsefor than}, until the endJ ^ Al-Bukhari, but not Muslim, collected this Hadith using this chain of narration, Ibn Hibban also collected it in his Sahib. 121 Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah said that the Prophet is, said, *3 <4% j*»- 71 fJU lSj ^ U» ‘li’fs ui :jjd 8Every person who does not pay the Zakdh due on his wealth, will have his money made into the shape of a bald-headed, poisonous male snake who will follow him . The person will run awayfrom the snake, who will follmv him and proclaim, T am your treasure/» ‘Abdullah then recited the Ayah in Allah’s Book that testifies to this fact, 4:— fji *i} ithe things that they were stingy with shall be tied to their necks like a collar on the Day ofResurrection .^ |3) This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi,141 An-Nasal, 151 and Ibn Fath Al-Bari 8:78. Ibn Hibban 5 : 107 (31 Ahmad 1 :377 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :393 |S| An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:317.

^ vt SUI? ^sn jj£;g.£*&sJti\j#8j 4^ O J4^ob S^Jjj&jdifiSiJs »> jj < -^u^ .a?. -' c£j^ijit<I^Oi<3^JVA^AtS .*14Air-so0^ Q-^J(Ir^jtllil 'fjJ j>t^ij 4£\$juijis=>i^dS^(^==^ ^4s4C^'^^ -^33.'jo^siyijjj^A-^jolj Majah, ' and At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih.” Allah’s statement, iu#%&&y*&> iAnd to Allah belongs the inheritance of the heavens and the Earth}, means, iand spend of that whereof He has made you trustees} [57:7]. Therefore, since all affairs are under Allah’s control, then spend from your money so it will benefit you on the Day of Return, o4~"t iand Allah is Well-Acquainted with all that you do.} with

your intentions and what your hearts conceal. jSBj ijtf c 4J&s && 4! \ rjii # iit yz 'A} -Jil jj L*j oil'j A ' i _£*» »4u^(l 4»- ^4-4 *5^ (3-31 J-^e. if fyu wjjjt .w'ju_il Jli) ij iiiii ^jjLj c.iiira 3j ji jUl' yC-H bit J*W dJJji ££ «AAi 0^ \nT (4AJ >A. <S ** Ibn Majah 2 :568 .

— Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4181. Indeed, Allah has heard the statement of those who say: Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!" We shall record what they have said and their killing of the Prophets unjustly, and We shall say: "Taste you the torment of the burning (Fire)." } il82. This is because of that which your hands have sent before you. And certainly, Allah is never unjust to (His) servants.} }183. Those who said: "Verily, Allah has taken our promise not to believe in any Messenger unless he brings to us an offering which the fire (from heaven) shall devour." Say: Verily, there came to you Messengers before me, with Al- Bayindt and even with with what you speak of; why then did you kill them, ifyou are truthful?"} il84. Then if they reject you, so ivere Messengers rejected before you, who came with Al-Bayinat and the Scriptures and the Book ofEnlightenment.} Allah Warns the Idolators SaW bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When Allah's statement, iWho is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan so that He may multiply it to him many times?} [2:245] was revealed, the Jews said, 'O Muhammad! Has your Lord become poor so that He asks His servants to give Him a loan?' Allah sent down, ilnecdd, Allah has heard the statement of those (Jews) who say "Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!"} [3:181]." This Hadlth was collected by Ibn Marduwyah and Ibn Abi Hatim. Allah's statement, i\J £ iWe shall record what they have said} contains a threat and a warning that Allah followed with His statement,

A i&JVf their killing of the Prophets unjustly,} This is what they say about Allah and this is how they treat His Messengers. Allah will punish them for these deeds in the worst manner, JliJ ilt o\> UIj uB'i w, ' jij* iyj*i iand We shall say: "Taste you the torment of the burning (Fire)." This is because of that which your hands have sent before you. And certainly, Allah is never unjust to (His) servants. } They will be addressed like this as a way of chastising, criticism, disgrace and humiliation. Allah said, Jj-0, - » ; iThose (Jeivs) who said: "Verily, Allah has taken our promise not to believe in any Messenger unless he brings to us an offering which the fire (from heaven) sluill devour."} Allah refuted their claim that in their Books, Allah took a covenant from them to only believe in the Messenger whose miracles include fire coming down from the sky that consumes the charity offered by a member of the Messenger's nation, as Ibn 'Abbas and Al-Hasan stated. Allah replied. £ J; iSay : "Verily, there came to you Messengers before me, xvith Al-Bayindt..."} with proofs and evidence, iand even with ivhat you speak of} a fire that consumes the accepted charity, as you asked,

4why then did you kill them? Why did you meet these Prophets with denial, defiance, stubbornness and even murder, iif you are truthful>, if you follow the truth and obey the Messengers?. Allah then comforts His Prophet Muhammad ag. •'< Of/ -Ui iThen if they reject you, so were Messengers rejected before you, who came with Al-Baiyyinat and the Scripture, and the Book ofEnlightenment. > meaning, do not be sad because they deny you, for you have an example in the Messengers who came before you. These Messengers were rejected although they brought clear proofs, plain evidence and unequivocal signs, iand the Zubur>, the divinely revealed Books that were sent down to the Messengers, t f&ivf \$and the Book of Enlightenment^ meaning the clarification and best explanation. if qJ-j ijS iLTi uXu -4 Kf 'Ciif {£jf 5tS JS && ^ rM? oi^ ^ ^ s, 143^i^r tjga 4135. Everyone shall taste death. And only on the Day of Resurrection shall you be paid your wages in full. And whoever is moved away from the Fire

and admitted to Paradise, It indeed is successful . The life of this world is only the enjoyment of deception . 4 4186. You shall certainly be tried and tested in your wealth and properties and in yourselves, and you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe

337 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) partners to Allah; but if you persevere patiently, and have Taqwa, then verily, that will be a determining factor in all affairs. Every Soul Shall Taste Death Allah issues a general and encompassing statement that every living soul shall taste death. In another statement, Allah said, iWhatsoever is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and Itonor will remain forever} [55:26,27]. Therefore, Allah Alone is the Ever-Living Who never dies, while the Jinn, mankind and angels, including those who carry Allah's Throne, shall die. The Irresistible One and Only, will alone remain for ever and ever, remaining Last, as He was the First. This Ayah comforts all creation, since every soul that exists on the earth shall die. When the term of this life comes to an end and the sons of Adam no longer have any new generations, and thus this world ends, Allah will command that the Day of Resurrection commence. Allah will then recompense the creation for their deeds, whether minor or major, many or few, big or small. Surely, Allah will not deal unjustly with anyone, even the weight of an atom, and this is why He said, iAnd only on the Day of Resurrection shall you be paid your wages in full [3:185]. Who Shall Gain Ultimate Victory? Allah said, iAnd whoever is moved away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful.} meaning, whoever is kept away from the Fire, saved from it and entered into Paradise, will have achieved the ultimate success.

339 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) insignificant as when one of you dips his finger in the sea; let him contemplate what his finger will come back with .n* 11 Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, ££ yi 'Gif Jf £j} iThe life of this world is only the enjoyment of deception.} "Life is a delight. By Allah, other than Whom there is no deity, it will soon fade away from its people. Therefore, take obedience to Allah from this delight, if you can. Verily, there is no power except from Allah." The Believer is Tested and Hears Grieving Statements from the Enemy Allah said, 4You shall certainly be tried and tested in your wealth and properties and in yourselves}, just as He said in another Ayah, JyVi y^ Jp ^ }&£& 4And certainly, I've shall test you with something of fear, hunger, loss of wealth, lives and fruits} [2:155]. Therefore, the believer shall be tested, in his wealth, himself, his offspring and family. The believer shall be tested according to the degree of his faith, and when his faith is stronger, the test is larger. /< Jt 'A>' S-ip Ir, (fP^&j} iand you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe partners to Allah} [3:186]. Allah said to the believers upon their arrival at Al-Madinah, before Badr, while comforting them against the harm they *** Muslim no. 2858, At-Tirmidhi no. 2324.

341 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions used to forgive the Mushriks and the People of the Scriptures, just as Allah commanded them, and they used to tolerate the harm that they suffered. Allah said. iatid you shall certainly hear much that will grieve you from those who received the Scripture before you (Jews and Christians) and from those who ascribe partners to Allah;) [3:186J, and, >3) 'J iMany of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Otristians) wish that they could turn you away as disbelievers after you have believed, out of envy from their own selves, even

after the truth has become manifest unto them. But forgive and overlook, till Allah brings His command) [2:109]. The Prophet used to implement the pardon that Allah commanded him until He gave His command (to fight the disbelievers). When the Messenger jg fought at Badr, and Allah killed, by his hand, the leaders of the disbelievers from Quraysh, ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul and the Mushriks and idol worshippers who were with him said, This matter has prevailed,’ and they gave their pledge to the Prophet jg and became Muslims.” Therefore, every person who stands for truth, enjoins righteousness and forbids evil, will be harmed in some manner. In such cases, there is no cure better than being patient in Allah’s cause, trusting in Him and returning to Him. 'jj o;Ull iiiii 3^ ji o' 0^3 Ofji C/j' CtJ— "iUS l_4c .a, 4*I>‘ *— ' -itt' *kj V A, >-jJ j»+)j 'yi jjl U }£y £L iifj I 1 * Al-Bukhari no. 4566, Muslim no. 1798.

4187. (And remember) when Allah took a covenant from those who were given the Scripture (Jeios and Christians) to make it (the truth) known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threio it away behind their backs, and purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed ivorst is that which they bought. 4188. Think not that those who rejoice in what they have done (or brought about), and love to be praised for what they have not done, think not that they are rescued from the torment, and for them is a painful torment. And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Allah has pmver over all things. Chastisingthe People ofthe Scriptures forBreakingthe Covenant and Hiding the Truth In this Ayah, Allah chastises the People of the Scriptures, from whom Allah took the covenant by the words of their Prophets, that they would believe in Muhammad jg and describe him to the people, so that they would recognize and follow him when Allah sent him. However, they hid this truth and preferred the the small amounts and the material gains instead of the rewards of this life and the Hereafter that they were promised. This is a losing deal and a failing trade, indeed. These Aydt also contain a warning for the scholars not to 1; mm J5 ijfo-i Jgj /'j ii 4*1 jfH'j ^j '.is <5&i. ' y' > 'i •?'

343Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) imitate their behavior, so that they do not suffer the same fate and become like them. Therefore, the scholars are required to spread the beneficial knowledge that they have, encouraging the various righteous good deeds. They are also warned against hiding any part of their knowledge. A Hadlth states that the Prophet *§ said, "Whoever was asked about knowledge that he knew but did not disclose it, will be tied with a bridle made offire on the Day of ResurrectionV 11 ChastisingThoseWho Love to be Praised forWhatThey Have not Done Allah’s statement, iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praisedfor what they have not done}, refers to those who show off, rejoice in what they do and claim to do what they have not done. The Two Sahihs recorded that

the Prophet jg said, nils VI 4ll eJjj t j&Oi. iiilS ^Whoever issues a false claim to acquire some type ofgain, then Allah will only grant him decrease . ,2) The Sahih. also recorded; “jjj Z/.y l -k*i pJ U-1 “He who claims to do what he has not done, is just like a person who wears tioo robes made offalsehood ,»131 Imam Ahmad recorded that Marwan told his guard Rafi‘ to go to Ibn ‘Abbas and proclaim to him, “If every person among us who rejoices with what he has done and loves to be praised for what he has not done will be tormented, we all will be At-Tabarani 8:401 ^ Al-Bukhari no. 6105, 6652 Muslim 1 :104. ^ Muslim no . 2129.

344 Tafoir Ibn Kathir tormented.” Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This Ayah was revealed about the People of the Scriptures.” He then recited the Ayah, oJxSi iyiSo "Jj illij iyjl S.-l' J^r* ^ }(And remember) when Allah took a covenant from those who were given the Scripture (Jews and Christians) to make it (the truth) known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threw it away behind their backs, and purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed worst is that which they bought.} then the Ayah, j3 £ .1 c-Sis :• iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praisedfor what they have not done Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Prophet jgg asked them about something, and they hid its knowledge, giving him an incorrect answer. They parted after showing off and rejoicing in front of him because they answered him, so they pretended, and they were delighted that they hid the correct news about what he had asked them.” 111 This was recorded by Al-Bukhari,*2 Muslim,*3 * At-Tirmidhi*4 * and An-Nasal.*51 Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said, “During the time of the Messenger of Allah jg;, when the Messenger jg would go to battle, some hypocrite men would remain behind and rejoice because they did not accompany the Prophet in battle. When the Messenger would come back, they would ask him to excuse them swearing to having some excuse, and wanting to be praised for that which they did not do. So Allah revealed, U o* 0^3 '_p' iiy-ji <£»)' 0; 111 Ahmad 1:298. 121 FathAl-Bari 8:81. * Muslim 4:2143. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8:66. * An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :318

345Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) iThink not that those who rejoice in what they have done, and love to be praisedfor what they have not done},” to the end of the Ayah.” And Muslim recorded similarly. 111 Allah said; ithink not that they are rescuedfrom the torment,} Do not think that they will be saved from punishment, rather it will certainly strike them. So Allah said; iU\ iandfor them is a painful torment .} Allah then said, iAnd to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Allah has poioer over all things.} He is the Owner of everything, able to do all things and nothing escapes His might. Therefore, fear Him, never defy Him and beware of His anger and revenge. He is the Most Great, none is greater than Him, and the Most Able, none is more able than He is. id' dji fig # 4 - s fir .•iff.' . "iif .r-r • t >r . >> ' \ ' >1' C' bj _vi3 b*v jb bi* ybj \x& y. bab*« bit b^> jb*a>l ^ oy*bibJ bl-^cj b bJbj l>j ' v4 bSjjj bJb a ji \£y'} bJ Hjj & V if.% 4290. Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the Earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding . } 4291 . Those who remember Allah standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides, and think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the earth, (saying) : “Our Lord! You have not Al-Bukhari 4567 and Muslim 2777.

created this without purpose, glory to You! Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire.} 1192 . "Our Lord! Verily, whom You admit to the Fire, indeed. You have disgraced him; and never will the wrongdoers find any helpers.} 1193. "Our Lord! Verily, we have heard the call ofone calling to faith: 'Believe in your Lord,' and we have believed. Our Lord! Forgive us our sins and expiate from us our evil deeds, and make us die along with Al-Abrar (the most righteous).} 4194. "Our Lord! Grant us what You promised us through Your Messengers and disgrace us not on the Day of Resurrection, for You never break (Your) Promise."} The Proofs ofTawhld for People ofUnderstanding, their Characteristics, Speech, and Supplications Allah said, i o-yCui 4 S\} 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the Earth,} [3:190], referring to the sky in its height and spaciousness, the earth in its expanse and density, the tremendous features they have of rotating planets, seas, mountains, deserts, trees, plants, fruits, animals, metals and various beneficial colors, scents, tastes and elements. 4And in the alternation ofnight and day}, as one follows and takes from the length of the other. For instance, at times one of

them becomes longer than the other, shorter than the other at times and equal to the other at other times, and the same is repeated again and again, and all this occurs by the decision of the Almighty, Most Wise. This is why Allah said, dji y\$} 4there are indeed signsfor men ofunderstanding}, referring to the intelligent and sound minds that contemplate about the true reality of things, unlike the deaf and mute who

347 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) do not have sound comprehension. Allah said about the latter type, * y > * > » > ' * ' < ' y An' * ii • -v * - Ay - '1 Jtji L*j Lyle- ufJJ'J J oi u^=yf (» * > yj 2» Vj i And how many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom. And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him} [12:105,106]. Allah then describes those who have good minds, iThose zoho remember Allah standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides [3: 191]. Al-Bukhari recorded that Imran bin Husayn said that, the Messenger of Allah said, Jjlii ^L:.L: jli t Ijuc-Ui jU jU i Uili J-i'i Pray while standing, and if you can't, pray while sitting, and if you cannot do even that, then pray lying on your side.® 11 ' These people remember Allah in all situations, in their heart and speech, iand think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the Earth}, contemplating about signs in the sky and earth that testify to the might, ability, knowledge, wisdom, will and mercy of the Creator. Allah criticizes those who do not contemplate about His creation, which testifies to His existence, Attributes, Shart'ah, His decree and Ayat. Allah said, iAnd how many a sign in the heavens and the Earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom. And most of them believe [il Path Al-Bari 2 :684

348 TafsTr Ibn Kathir not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him} [12:105,106], Allah also praises iThose who remember Allah standing, sitting, and lying down on their sides, and think deeply about the creation of the heavens and the earth}, supplicating; i- U Gj} 4"Our Lord! You have not created this without purpose,"} You did not create all this in jest and play. Rather, You created it in truth, so that You recompense those who do evil in kind, and reward those who do righteous deeds with what is better. The faithful believers praise Allah and deny that He does anything in jest and without purpose, saying, 4&£Cf*} A "S^ory to You,"}, for You would never create anything without purpose, 4j& jS'ji \£} 4"Give us salvation from the torment of the Fire."}, meaning, "O You Who created the creation in truth and justice, Who is far from any shortcomings, or doing things without purpose or with jest, save us from the torment of the Fire with Your power and strength. Direct us to perform the deeds that make You pleased with us. Guide us to righteous work from which You admit us into the delightful Paradise, and save us from Your painful torment." They next supplicate, 4ZP 'M £4 ;;} 4"Our Lord! Verily, whom You admit to the Fire, indeed. You have disgraced him;}, by humiliating and disgracing him before all people on the Day of Gathering,

4"and never will the wrongdoers find any helpers."}, on the Day of Judgment, who would save them from You. Therefore, there is no escaping whatever fate You decided for them. iLlt. <^W,} 4"Our Lord! Verily, we have heard the call of one calling to faith/% a caller who calls to faith, referring to the Messenger of Allah ^ ~//~/. !>U' i'Believe in your Lord/ and we have believed}, accepted his call and followed him. 4^/y> tJ ££j 4"Our Lord! Forgive us our sins"}, on account of our faith and obeying Your Prophet jg 4C£ a -jp/} 4"Forgive us our sins"}, and cover them, 4"and expiate from us our evil deeds"}, between us and You, in private, 4"and make us die along with Al-Abrdr."}, join us with the righteous

people. 4ii^>j u \£j} 4"Our Lord! Grant us what You promised unto us through Your Messengers"} for our faith in Your Messengers, or, and this explanation is better; grant us what You promised us by the words of Your Messengers,

i"and disgrace us not on the Day ofResurrection,"}, before all creation, Jail v^} A"for You never break (Your) Promise."}, for surely, the promise that You conveyed to Your Messengers, which includes us being resurrected before You, shall certainly come to pass. It was the Prophet's tradition to recite the ten Ayat at the end of [Surah] Al 'Imran when he woke up at night for (voluntary) prayer. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I slept one night at the house of my aunt, Maymunah. The Messenger of Allah jg spoke with his wife for a while and then went to sleep. When it was the third part of the night, he stood up, looked at the sky and recited, 4 J jfSPj yiL j Zfjf} iVerily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding} [3:190]. The Prophet jg then stood up, performed ablution, used Siwak (to clean his teeth) and prayed eleven units of prayer. When Bilal said the Adhan, the Prophet prayed two units of prayer, went out (to the Masjid] and led the people in the Dawn prayer. "I 1 * This was also collected by Muslim. 12 Ibn Marduwyah recorded that 'Ata' said, "I, Ibn TJmar and TJbayd bin TJmayr went to 'A'ishah and entered her room, and there was a screen between us and her. She said, 'O TJbayd! What prevents you from visiting us?' He said, What the poet said, Visit every once in a while, and you will be loved more.' Ibn 'Umar said, Tell us about the most unusual thing you witnessed from the Messenger of Allah She cried and said, 'All his matters were amazing. On night, he came close to me until his skin touched my skin and said, 'Let me worship my Fath. Al-Bari 8 :83 121 Muslim 1 :530.

5*^ 'jv-' Si i j \£~±ij 4i/j»A> j ./ *- »« »*(, »i/f/ * ./#/ 7^fx' (*4^* J J&) ||l il^ijlljj£l&>-ppJ* jA> » "*" *» })*** "i* * „V^^ c/Oj-? fHp jJH " - i<&(c^l^Oj_-Ls -^: p-fc *>LJs 1 S^""^ 'Up^ . ^p<— ^Jrt/" QJ^SSSS vi spiju V, Lord.' I said, 'By Allah Ax' '1 ->>-" '*\ ' *-t- II I love your being close to me. I also love that you worship your Lord.' He used the water-skin and performed ablution, but did not use too much water. He then stood up in prayer and cried until his beard became wet. He prostrated and cried until he made the ground wet. He then laid down on his side and cried. When Bilal came to alert the Prophet M, for the Dawn prayer, he said, 'O Messenger of Allah! What makes you cry, while Allah has forgiven you your previous and latter sins?' He ig said, haJQJI «jii ^ l^s- Jyl lij 'Cs\$ oi l_s~niL Lj <JtL ! j nO Bilal! What prevents me from crying, when this night, this Ayah was revealed to me,» ^p^dVt &&\$ # 4 iVerily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding.\$ «144 'AJ JdJ «VVoe to he who recites it but does not contemplate iM." ' Mawarid Az-Zaman no . 139.

Jam C£ fLiva ^ fi- V <4^ (t-#j > rn^s*" rt^6 'Ai*> 'A^J j bfAj (r?^i o; b>>-ti 0-^-)U \$j %\ X* £ 6? j#Vf oj ^ (^yij 4#i\$‘ 4195. So their Lord accepted of them (their supplication and answered them), "Never will I allow to be lost the work ofany ofyou, be he male orfemale. You are (members) one ofanother, so those who emigrated and were driven out from their homes, and suffered harm in My cause, and wlfought and were killed (in My cause), verily, I will expiatefrom them their evil deeds and admit them into Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise); a reward from Allah, and with Allah is the best of rewards. AllahAccepts the Supplication ofMen ofUnderstanding Allah said, 4So their Lord accepted of thetn}, answered their invocation. Said bin Mansur recorded that Salamah, a man

from the family of Umm Salamah said, "Umm Salamah said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Allah does not mention women in connection with Hijrah (Migration).' Allah sent down the Ayah, 4\$ So their Lord accepted of them (their supplication and answered them), "Never will I allow to be lost the work of any of you, be he male or female. The Ansar say that Umm Salamah was the first woman to migrate to them." 111 Al-Hakim collected this Hadith in his Afistadraf, 12* and said, "It is Sahih according to the criteria of Al-Bukhari but they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not collect it". Allah's statement, Said bin Mansur 3 :1 136. 121 Al-Hakim 2:300.

Stlrah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) 353 4 i' J>- jH? 1 V4^ 4"Never will I allow to be lost the work of any of you, be he male or female,\$ explains the type of answer Allah gave them, stating that no deed of any person is ever lost with Him. Rather, He will completely reward each person for his or her good deeds. Allah's statement, 41*S*^ 4You are (members) one of another means, you are all equal in relation to gaining My reward. Therefore, those who emigrated}, by leaving the land of Shirk and migrating to the land of faith, leaving behind their loved ones, brethren, friends and neighbors, and were driven out from their homes}, when the Mushriks tormented them and forced them to migrate, and suffered harm in My cause}, for their only wrong, to the people, was that they believed in Allah Alone. In similar Ayat, Allah said, and have driven out the Messenger and yourselves because you believe in Allah your Lord!} [60:1], and, 4 J ijili £)} 4And they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy of all praise!} [85:8] . Allah's statement, 4jLjj ' ^)} and who fought and were killed (in My cause),} [3:195]

Stlrah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4 throughout the land deceive you.) 4197. A brief enjoyment; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.} 4198. But, for those who have Taqwa of their Lord, are Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise); therein are they to dwell, an entertainment from Allah; and that which is with Allah is the best for Al-Abrdr (the most righteous).}

Warning Against Being Deceived by This Life; the Rewards of the Righteous Believers Allah said, do not look at the disbelievers, who are enjoying various delights and joys. Soon, they will lose all this and be tied to their evil works, for verily, we are only giving them time, which deceives them, when all they have is, p+j'- 3 4A brief enjoyment; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest. ^ This Ayah is similar to several other Ayat, such as, 42" \$!# aM^ s^L\\ Xi iNone disputes in the Ayat of Allah but those who disbelieve. So, let not their ability of going about here and there through the land deceive you!} [40:4], 4f'ojf&> tL jujlIj' JL+Li! % 4Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} [10:69,70], 4We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment.} [31:24], & & 4So, give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them for

V i"r*' er) 'Jj'I bj 3^* ' <>3 1 ~5S3' j; ^j—• iit '—'1 (*#J JL*^ p-*j-»-t |i\$! -^—lj'. ii' Iji3i> i'iu'j.) ^y»*U .*^>jj' ijjbj 4:k^ 4199. And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah. They do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price, for them is a reward with their Lord. Surely, Allah is swift in account. 4 4200. O you who believe! Endure and be more patient, and Rabitii, and have Taqwd of Allah, so that you may be

successful.} The Condition of Some of the People of the Scriptures and their Rewards Allah states that some of the People of the Book truly believe in Him and in what was sent down to Muhammad jg, along with believing in the previously revealed Books, and they are obedient to Him and humble themselves before Allah. 4" M it i They do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price [3:199], for they do not hide what they know of the glad tidings about the description of Muhammad sg, his Prophethood, and the description of his Ummah. Indeed, these are the best people among the People of the Book, whether they were Jews or Christians. Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas, jilt *1 I#l UA. ijiii ^ ^ @o>* <5; -a (** ot 4itii ti C*>” *43 & } Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say: 'We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we were Muslims. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient,} [28:52-54]. Allah said.

4-* ' ^7*^ %>Vj j*. jyli i Those to whom We gave the Book, recite it (follow it) as it should be recited (i.e. followed), they are the ones who believe therein.} [2:121], 4 -its is' &y o/ the people of Musa there is a community who lead with truth and establish justice therewith.} [7:159), •A " «*» \$ iSt; 94c \$£_ til ^£SJ £ *£ f,lp 4Nof all of them are alike ; a party of the people of the Scripture stand for the right, they recite the verses of Allah during the hours of the night, prostrating themselves in prayer.} [3:113], and, (jUiSii oj_y£ |V(i J-i Ot pM' iyj' "j-sy V _)' i * > " iCtir. " -i /- >" / l' 7,/ «» <* •> ^ •? > U_j o» iSay : “Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration." And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled." And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.} [17:107- 109], These qualities exist in some of the Jews, but only a few of them. For instance, less than ten Jewish rabbis embraced the Islamic faith, such as ‘Abdullah bin Salam. Many among the Christians, on the other hand, embraced the Islamic faith. Allah said, 4U^£q IjUr. Sj# i Verily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say: "We

359 Surah 3 . Al 'Imran (Part-4) are Christians."} [5:82], until, tjie Oj y~>- 'jH» <U>i ^ So because of what they said, Allah rewarded them Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise), they will abide therein forever [5:85]. In this Ayah, Allah said, ^br them is a reward with their Lord [3:199]. When Jafar bin Abi Talib recited Surah Maryam [chapter 19] to An-Najashi, King of Ethiopia, in the presence of Christian priests and patriarchs, he and they cried until their beards became wet from crying. 1 11 The Two Sahlhs record that when An-Najashi died, the Prophet jg conveyed the news to his Companions and said, \jLZai coU !ii U-l jl» “A brother of yours from Ethiopia has passed, come to offer the funeral prayer.» He went out with the Companions to the Musalla lined them up in rows, and after that led the prayer.12 Ibn Abi Najih narrated that Muj&hid said that, * i\$} i And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture}, refers to those among them who embraced Islam.’3 ‘Abbad bin MansQr said that he asked Al-Hasan Al-Basri about Allah’s statement, i And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah}. Al-Hasan said, “They are the People of the Book, before Muhammad -g? was sent, who believed in Muhammad ^ and Ibn Hisham 1 :357. * Fath Al-Bari 7 :230 , Muslim 2 :657 * At-Jabari 7:499.

recognized Islam. Allah gave them a double reward, for the faith that they had before Muhammad ﷺ, and for believing in Muhammad ﷺ (after he was sent as Prophet).” Ibn Abi Hatim recorded both of these statements. The Two Sahihs record that Abu Musa said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “Three persons will acquire a double reward. He mentioned among them, the Jew, the Christian, and the Magian. A person from among the People of the Book who believed in his Prophet and in me. Allah’s statement, ‘They do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price’, means, they do not hide the knowledge that they have, as the cursed ones among them have done. Rather, they share the knowledge without a price, and this is why Allah said, ‘for them is a reward with their Lord, surely, Allah is Swift in account.’” Mujahid commented on the verse, ‘(Surely, Allah is) swift in account’, “He is swift in reckoning,” as Ibn Abi Hatim and others have recorded from him. The Command for Patience and Ribat Allah said, “O you who believe! Endure and be more patient, and remember that [3:200]. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “The believers are commanded to be like Fath Al-Bari 6 : 169 , Muslim 1 : 134

patient in the religion that Allah chose for them, Islam. They are not allowed to abandon it in times of comfort or hardship, ease or calamity, until they die as Muslims. They are also commanded to endure against their enemies, those who hid the truth about their religion.” 1,1 Similar explanation given by several other scholars among the Salaf. As for Murabatah, it is to endure in acts of worship and perseverance. It also means to await prayer after prayer, as Ibn ‘Abbas, Sahl bin Hanf and Muhammad bin Ka’b Al-Qurazi stated. Ibn Abi Hatim collected a Hadith that was also collected by Muslim and An-Nasai from Abu Hurayrah that

the Prophet ﷺ said, “Should I tell you about actions with which Allah forgives sins and raises the grade? Performing perfect ablution in unfavorable conditions, the many steps one takes to the Masjid, and awaiting prayer after the prayer, for this is the Ribat, this is the Ribat, this is the Ribat.” 21 They also say that the Murabatah in the above Ayah refers to battles against the enemy, and manning Muslim outposts to protect them from enemy incursions inside Muslim territory. There are several Hadiths that encourage Murabatah and mention its rewards. Al-Bukhari recorded that Sahl bin Sa’d As-Saldi said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “A Day of Ribat in the cause of Allah is better than this life and all that is in it.” Muslim recorded that Salman Al-Farisi said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “The Ribat is better than the world and all that is in it.” Muslim 1 : 219, An-Nasai 1 : 89. Al-Bukhari no . 2892

“Let the servant of the Dinar, the servant of the Dirham and the servant of the Khamisah (of clothes) perish, as he is pleased if these things are given to him, and if not, he is displeased. Let such a person perish and be humiliated, and if he is pierced with a thorn, let him not find anyone to take it out for him. Paradise is for him who holds the reins of his horse, striving in Allah's cause, with his hair unkempt and feet covered with dust : if he is appointed to the vanguard, he is perfectly satisfied with his post of guarding, and if he is appointed in the rearguard, he accepts his post with satisfaction; if he asks for permission he is not permitted, and if he intercedes, his intercession is not accepted.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Zayd bin Aslam said, “Abu Tjibaydah wrote to ‘Umar bin Al-Khattab and mentioned to him that the Romans were mobilizing their forces. ‘Umar wrote back, ‘Allah will soon turn whatever hardship a believing servant suffers, to ease, and no hardship shall ever overcome two types of ease. Allah says in His Book, ‘O you who believe!

Endure and be more patient, and Rdbitii, and have Taqwa of Allah, so that you may be successful[^] (3:200]. Al-Hafiz Ibn 'Asakir mentioned in the biography of 'Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak, that Muhammad bin Ibrahim bin Abi Saknah said, "While in the area of Tarsus, 'Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak dictated this poem to me when I was greeting him goodbye. He sent the poem with me to Al-Fudayl bin "Iyfid in the year one hundred and seventy, 'O he who worships in the vicinity of the Two Holy .Masjids ! If you but see us, you will realize that you are only jesting in worship. He who brings wetness to his cheek with his tears, should know that our necks are being wet by our blood. He who tires his horses 111 Al-Bukh&ri no. 2886. 121 At-Tabari 7 :503.

without purpose, know that our horses are getting tired in battle. Scent of perfume is yours, while our scent is the glimmer of spears and the stench of dust [in battle]. We were narrated about in the speech of our Prophet, an authentic statement that never lies. That the dust that erupts by Allah's horses and which fills the nostrils of a man shall never be combined with the smoke of a raging Fire. This, the Book of Allah speaks among us that the martyr is not dead, and the truth in Allah's Book cannot be denied.' I met Al-Fudayl Ibn lyad in the Sacred Masjid and gave him the letter. When he read it, his eyes became tearful and he said, 'Abu 'Abdur- Rahman ('Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak) has said the truth and offered sincere advice to me.' He then asked me, "Do you write the Hadith?' I said, 'Yes.' He said, "Write this Hadith as reward for delivering the letter of Abu 'Abdur-Rahman to me. He then dictated, 'Mansur bin Al-Mutamir narrated to us that Abu Salih narrated from Abu Hurayrah that a man asked, 'O Messenger of Allah! Teach me a good deed that will earn me the reward of the Mujahidin in Allah's cause.' The Prophet jg said, you able to pray continuously and fast without breaking thefast? The man said, 'O Messenger of Allah! I cannot bear it.' The Prophet jg said, ^ j' 'J 1 ' U «ilJi osjt j l_rr<si ijJlji "By Me in Whose Hand is my soul! Even ifyou were able to do it, you will not achieve the grade of the Mujahidin in Allah's cause. Did you not know that the horse of the Mujahid earns rewardsfor him as long as it lives. Allah said next, iand have Taqzoa of Allah}, concerning all your affairs and m Ahmad 5 :236

situations. For instance, the Prophet jfe said to Mu'adh when he sent him to Yemen, jLL >01 jJUj 01=01 02JI cdlS U*> Sil Jh aHave Taqzvd of Allah wherever you may be, follcno the evil deed ivitli a good deed and it ivill erase it, and deal with people in a good manner .n11 ' Allah said next, 4so that you may be successful.}, in this life and the Hereafter. Ibn Jarir recorded that Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi said that, Allah's statement, 'if <\$and have Taqwa ofAllah, so that you may be successful. means, "Fear Me concerning what is between you and Me, so that you may acquire success when you meet Me tomorrow."121

The Tafsir of Surah Al 'Imran ends here, all praise is due to Allah, and we ask Him that we die while on the path of the Qur'an and Sunnah, Amin. 111 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 : 123 121 At-Jabari 7:510.

Surah 4: An-Nisa

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The Tafsirof SuratAn-Nisa

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(Chapter 4) Virtues of SuratAn-Nisa A Madinan Surah Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Surat An-Nisa’ was revealed in Al-Madlnah. Ibn Marduwyah recorded similar statements from ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr and Zayd bin Thabit. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'Ud said, “There are five Ayat in Surat An-Nisa’ that I would prefer to the life of this world and all that is in it, ^ ij 3ii£* (ttlii 'i si' i Surely, Allah wrongs not even the weight of an atom,) (4:40), if you avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do (4:31), JI} 6jj C ju£ 4r-i ^ ^ Sit i Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but He forgives except that (anything else) to whom He wills (4:48), p \$j} iff they (hypocrites), when they had been unjust to themselves, had come to you (4:64), and, u gj jtyUP i' 4llt ji*')it 'it 'l >' s* (4^; o' i And whoever does evil or wrongs himself, but afterwards seeks Allah’s forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful (4:110).” 111 Al-Hakim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Ask me about Surat An-Nisa’, for I learned the Qur’an when I was still young.” Al-Hakim said, “This Hadith is Sahih according to the criteria of the Two Sahih, and they did not collect it.” 111 Al-Hakim 2:305. 121 Al-Hakim 2 :301

The Command to have Taqwa, a Reminder about Creation, and Being Kind to Relatives Allah commands His creatures to have Tciqwa of Him by worshipping Him Alone without partners. He also reminds to them of His ability, in that He created them all from a single person, Adam, peace be unto him. i And from him He created his wife) Hawwa’ (Eve), who was created from Adam’s left rib, from his back while he was sleeping. When Adam woke up and saw Hawwa’, he liked her

and had affection for her, and she felt the same toward him. An authentic Hadith states, O-J&S 1 ^ ijl i C~4i>- sLlJl jU gyi t\$jj ^ <* Woman was created from a rib. Verily, the most curved portion of the rib is its upper part, so, if you should try to straighten it, you will break it, but if you leave it as it is, it will remain crooked .n * Allah’s statement, i'3X i And from them both He created many men and women;} means, Allah created from Adam and Hawwa’ many men and women and distributed them throughout the world in various shapes, characteristics, colors and languages. In the end, their gathering and return will be to Allah. Allah then said, ijc&j 4' & i And have Taqwa of Allah through Whom you demand your mutual (rights) and revere the wombs}, protect yourself from Allah by your acts of obedience to Him. Allah’s statement, i through Whom you demand your mutual (rights)}, is in reference to when some people say, “I ask you by Allah, and then by the relation of the Rahim (the womb, i.e. my relationship to you)”, according to Ibrahim, Mujahid and Al- Hasan.*2 Ad-Dahhak said; “Fear Allah Whom you invoke when you conduct transactions and contracts.” 131 “And revere the womb by not cutting the relations of the womb, but keep and honor them, as Ibn ‘Abbas, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Ad-

Dahhak, Ar-Rabl', and others have stated.*4 111 Path Al-Bari 6 :4 1 At-Tabari 7:519. 131 At-Tabari 7:518. 141 At-Tabari 7:521,522.

370 Tafoir Ibn Kathir Allah's statement, iSurely, Allah is always watching over you. means, He watches all your deeds and sees your every circumstance. In smother Ayah, Allah said; 4-^&\$& iAnd Allah is Witness over all things.} [58:6]. An authentic Hadith states, 2lt JupU «Worship Allah as ifyou see Him, for even though you cannot see Him, He sees you.® This part of the Ayah encourages having a sense of certainty that Allah is always watching, in a complete and perfect manner. Allah mentioned that He has created mankind from a single father and a single mother, so that they feel compassion for each other and are kind to the weaker among them. In his SahSh, Muslim recorded that Jarir bin 'Abdullah Al-Bajali said that a delegation from Mudar came to the Messenger of Allah gj, and he saw their state, wearing striped woolen clothes due to poverty. After the Zuhr prayer, the Messenger of Allah stood up and gave a speech in which he recited. <}*> Ji#£ d# fiS& iO mankind! Have Taqwa ofyour Lord, Who created youfrom a single person,} until the end of the Ayah. He jg also recited. assess jjM; -m \$£> 40 you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah. And let every person look to what he has sent forth for the tomorrow> [59:18]. He also encouraged them to give charity, saying, 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :140.

ijM j 'is. p-® yt iri ji jj-*' 1 «A man gave Sadaqah from his Dinar, from his Dirham, from his Sd' of wheat, from his Sd' of dateso until the end of the Hadith.™ This narration was also collected by Ahmad and the Sunan compilers from Ibn Mas'ud.121 Sf %^ di && -2; Vi \$ # c &s 4^\$\$*&04 % rqt ifo j-fe# c \$ Is# 4:|5<v fei a 15^^ a 42 . And give unto orphans their property and do not exchange (your) bad things for (their) good ones; and devour not their substance (by adding it) to your substance. Surely, this is a great sin.} <3 . And if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women of your choice, two or three, orfour; but ifyou fear that you shall not be able to deal justly (with them), then only one or (the captives and the servants) that your right hands possess. That is nearer to prevent youfrom Ta'ulu.} 44. And give to the women (whom you marry) their Saduqat (or dowry) Nihlah (with a good heart), but if they, of their own good pleasure, remit any part of it to you, take it, and enjoy it withoutfear ofany harm.} Protecting the Property ofthe Orphans Allah commands that the property of the orphans be surrendered to them in full when they reach the age of adolescence, and He forbids using or confiscating any part of it. So He said; 141 %} 111 Muslim 2:705. 121 Ahmad 4 :358, An-Nasal 5 :75 Ibn MSjah 1 :74.

and do not exchange (your) bad thingsfor (their) good ones;} Said bin Al-Musayyib and Az-Zuhri commented, "Do not substitute a weak animal of yours for a fat animal (of the orphans)." * Ibrahim An-Nakhal and Ad-Dahhak commented, "Do not give something of bad quality for something of good quality." 121 As-Suddi said, "One of them (caretakers of orphans) would take a fat sheep from the orphan's property and put in its place, a weak sheep of his, saying, 'A sheep for a sheep.' He would also take a good Dirham and exchange it for a fake Dirham, saying, 'A Dirham for a Dirham.'" [3' Allah's statement, iW' & iand devour not their substance to your substance.} means, do not mix them together so that you eat up both, as Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan, As-Suddi and Sufyan bin Hassln stated. Allah said, X ft} iSurely, this is a great sin.}, a major and substantial sin, according to Ibn 'Abbas.*51 This was also reported from Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Ibn Sirin,

Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Malik, Zayd bin Aslam and Abu Sinan.*6 The meaning above is: adding their property to your property is a grave sin and a major mistake, so avoid it.

The Prohibition of Marrying Female Orphans Without

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Giving a Dowry Allah said, *£\$Zpi&t 4^ ii>}* ,l * At-Jabari 7:525. At-Jabari 7:525. <31 At-Jabari 7:526. At-Jabari 7:528. At-Tabari 7:530. 161 At-Jabari 7:530.

4And if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women of your choice, two} Allah commands, when one of you is the caretaker of a female orphan and he fears that he might not give her a dowry that is suitable for women of her status, he should marry other women, who are plenty as Allah has not restricted him. Al-Bukhan recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “A man was taking care of a female orphan and he married her, although he did not desire to marry her. That girl’s money was mixed with his, and he was keeping her portion from her. Afterwards, this Ayah was revealed about his case; if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly}”¹¹ ‘ Al-Bukhari recorded that OJrwah bin Az-Zubayr said that he asked ‘A’ishah about the meaning of the statement of Allah, if you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls.} She said, “O my nephew! This is about the orphan girl who lives with her guardian and shares his property. Her wealth and beauty may tempt him to marry her without giving her an adequate dowry which might have been given by another suitor. So, such guardians were forbidden to marry such orphan girls unless they treated them justly and gave them the most suitable dowry; otherwise they were ordered to marry woman besides them.” ‘A’ishah further said, “After that verse, the people again asked the Messenger of Allah jg (about marriage with orphan girls), so Allah revealed the Ayah, 4m a&&& iThey ask your instruction concerning the women..} [4:127).” She said, “Allah’s statement in this Ayah, m Fath Al-Bari 8 :87 .

374 Tahir Ibn Kathir iyet whom you desire to marry^ [4:127) refers to the guardian who does not desire to marry an orphan girl under his supervision because she is neither wealthy nor beautiful. The guardians were forbidden to marry their orphan girls possessing property and beauty without being just to them, as they generally refrain from marrying them (when they are neither beautiful nor wealthy).”
111 The Permission to Marry Four Women Allah’s statement, 4two or three, or four}, means, marry as many women as you like, other than the orphan girls, two, three or four. We should mention that Allah’s statement in (mother Ayah, 4Who made the angels messengers with wings, - two or three orfour} [35:1], does not mean that other angels do not have more than four wings, as there are proofs that some angels do have more wings. Yet, men are prohibited from marrying more than four wives, as the Ayah decrees, since the Ayah specifies what men are allowed of wives, as Ibn ‘Abbas and the majority of scholars stated. If it were allowed for them to have more than four wives, the Ayah would have mentioned it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Salim said that his father said that Ghllan bin Salamah Ath-Thaqafi had ten wives when he became Muslim, and the Prophet sg said to him, “Choose any four of them (and divorce the rest).” During the reign of Umar, Ghllan divorced his remaining wives and divided his money between his children. When TJmar heard news of this, he said to Ghllan, “I think that the devil has conveyed to your heart the news of your imminent death, from what the devil hears

during his eavesdropping. It may as well be that you will not remain alive but for a little longer. By Allah! You will take back your wives and your money, or I will take possession of this all and will order that your grave be stoned as is the case with the 111 FathAl-BtSri 8:87.

grave of Abu Righal (from ThamQd, who was saved from their fate because he was in the Sacred Area. But, when he left it, he was tormented like they were).” Ash-Shafil, At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, Ad-Daraqutni and Al-Bayhaqi collected this Hadith up to the Prophet’s statement, “Choose any four of them.” Only Ahmad collected the full version of this Hadith. Therefore, had it been allowed for men to marry more than four women at the same time, the Prophet would have allowed Ghllan to keep more than four of his wives since they all embraced Islam with him. When the Prophet commanded him to keep just four of them and divorce the rest, this indicated that men are not allowed to keep more than four wives at a time under any circumstances. If this is the case concerning those who already had more than four wives upon embracing Islam, then this ruling applies even more so to marrying more than four. Marrying Only One Wife When One Fears He Might not Do Justice to His Wives Allah’s statement, “If you fear that you will not be able to deal justly (with them), then only one or what your right hands possess.” The Ayah commands, if you fear that you will not be able to do justice between your wives by marrying more than one, then marry only one wife, or satisfy yourself with only female captives, for it is not obligatory to treat them equally, rather it is recommended. So if one does so, that is good, and if not, there is no harm on him. In another Ayah, Allah said, “You will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire” [4:129]. Allah said, “1 * Ahmad 2:14, Al-Umm 5:49, At-Tirmidhi no.1128, Ibn Majah no.1953, Ad-Daraqutni 3 :271 Al-Bayhaqi 7 :182.

“That is nearer to prevent you from Ta’iilu}, meaning, from doing injustice. Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduwyah and Abu Hatim Ibn Hibban, in his Sahih, recorded that ‘A’ishah said that, the Prophet said that the Ayah, “4”)Lyu Vi yjl “That is nearer to prevent you from Ta’iilu}, means, from doing injustice.” However, Ibn Abi Hatim said that his father said that this Hadith to the Prophet is a mistake, for it should be attributed to ‘A’ishah not the Prophet. Ibn Abi Hatim reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘A’ishah, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Abu Malik, Abu Razin, An-Nakhal, Ash-Sha’bi, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan that Ta’ulu means to deviate [from justice].”2 ‘ Giving the Dowry is Obligatory ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported Ibn ‘Abbas saying, “Nihlah, in Allah’s statement, “And give to the women (whom you marry) their Saduqat Nihlah” refers to the dowry.”3 Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated from Az-Zuhri that Tirmidhi said that ‘A’ishah said that ‘Nihlah’ means ‘obligatory’. Muqatil, Qatadah and Ibn Jurayj said, “Nihlah’ means ‘obligatory’ Ibn Jurayj added: ‘specified.’”4 ‘ Ibn Zayd said, “In Arabic, Nihlah, refers to what is necessary. So Allah is commanding: Do not marry unless you give your wife something that is her right. No person after the Prophet is allowed to marry a woman except with the required dowry, nor by giving false promises about the dowry [intended].”5 ‘ Therefore, the man is required” Ibn Hibban 6:134. 121 At-Tabari 7:549-551. ,3’ At-Tabari 7 :553 4) At-Tabari 7 :553 [S] At-Tabari 7:553.

to pay a dowry to his wife with a good heart, just as he gives a gift with a good heart. If the wife gives him part or all of that dowry with a good heart, her husband is allowed to take it, as it is lawful for him in this case. This is why Allah said afterwards, “But if they, of their own pleasure, remit any part of it to

you, take it, and enjoy it without fear of any harm.) # i ft&& Jf *»' jsfc* ££^ppc4 'd® !& tSi !&; ^ 6* ^ P Stam fill; 4\$^A\$& pi^ <5. And give not unto the unwise your wealth which Allah has made a means of support for you, but feed and clothe them therewith, and speak to them in words of kindness and justice.) 46. And test orphans until they reach the age of marriage; if then you find sound judgment in them, release their property to them, but consume it not wastefully and hastily, fearing that they should grow up. And whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself

what is just and reasonable (according to his work) . And when

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you release their property to them, take a witness in their presence; and Allah is All-Sufficient in taking account.) Holding the Property of the Unwise in Escrow Allah prohibited giving the unwise the freedom to do as they wish with wealth, which Allah has made as a means of support for people. This ruling sometimes applies because of being young, as young people are incapable of making wise decisions. It also applies in cases of insanity, erratic behavior and having a weak intellect or religious practice. It applies in cases of bankruptcy, when the debtors ask that the property of a bankrupt person is put in escrow, when his debts cannot be paid off with his money. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement.

Stirah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-4, 379 {And test orphans^ meaning, test their intelligence, as Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan stated.¹¹ ' until they reach the age of marriage}, the age of puberty, according to Mujahid.² ' The age of puberty according to the majority of scholars comes when the child has a wet dream. In his Sunan, Abu Dawud recorded that ‘Ali said, “I memorized these words from the Messenger of Allah jg, <jdbi Ji f>; ij i ^i JJJ 'j uThere is no orphan after the age of puberty nor vowing to be silent throughout the day to the night .»’³ In another HadUh, ‘A’ishah and other Companions said that

the Prophet jg said, csj Js- ^ ^ Ji 4* Is _ -r .f * ' 4ds£ tj «The pen does not record the deeds of three persons : the child until the age of puberty, the sleeping person until waking up, and the senile until sane.»⁴ Or, the age of fifteen is considered the age of adolescence. In the Two SahXhs, it is recorded that Ibn TJmar said, “I was presented in front of the Prophet on the eve of the battle of Uhud, while I was fourteen years of age, and he did not allow me to take part in that battle. But I was presented in front of him on the eve of the battle of Al-Khandaq (The Trench) when I was fifteen years old, and he allowed me (to join that battle).” “Umar bin ‘Abdul-‘Aziz commented when this HadUh reached him, “This is the difference between a child and an adult.”⁵ There is a difference of opinion over whether pubic hair is f1 ' At-Tabari 7:574. ²| At-Tabari 7:575. 131 Abu Dawud 3:293. 141 Abu Dawud 4:558-560. 's ' Al-Bukhari no. 2664, Muslim no.1868.

considered a sign of adulthood, and the correct opinion is that it is. The Sunnah supports this view, according to a Hadith collected by Imam Ahmad' from ‘Atiyah Al-Qurazi who said, We were presented to the Prophet jg on the day of Qurizah, whoever had pubic hair was killed, whoever did not was left free to go, I was one of those who did not, so I was left free.” The Four Sunan compilers also recorded

similar to it.' ' At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih." Allah's statement, if then you find sound judgment in them, release their property to them,} Said bin Jubayr said that this portion of the Ayah means, when you find them to be good in the religion and wise with their money. Similar was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others among the Imams.'3 ' The scholars of Fiqh stated that when the child becomes good in the religion and wise concerning with money, then the money that his caretaker was keeping for him should be surrendered to him. Poor Caretakers are Allowed to Wisely Spend from the Money of the Orphan Under Their Care, to Compensate for Their Work Allah said, o' 'Jjj 'ij} iBut consume it not wastefully and hastily, fearing that they should grow up.} Allah commands that the money of the orphan should not be spent unnecessarily, 4j'V 4Wastefully and hastily} for fear they might grow up. Allah also commands, Ahmad 4:310. ' Abu Dawud 4:561, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:207, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 5:185, Ibn Majah 2 :849 ' At-Tabari 7:576.

ol? J^j} iAnd whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages,} Hence, the guardian who is rich and does not need the orphan's money, should not take any of it as wages. &&\M <4& ibut if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'A'ishah said, "This Ayah, 4x& u iAnd whoever among guardians is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable.} was revealed about the guardian of the orphan and pertains to whatever work he does for the orphan's estate." 1 11 Al-Bukhari also collected this Hadithj21 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb said that his father said that his father told him that a man asked the Messenger of Allah jg, "I do not have money, but I have an orphan under my care." The Messenger said, Jjila {jp O ji {jAJ (Jill* 'jj jil* Vj jj- iiJU - Jll j\ - *Eat from your orphan's wealth without extravagance or wastefulness, or mixing it, and without saving your money by spending his.*" Allah said, 'pA %} iAnd when you release their property to them.} after they become adults, and you see that they are wise, then, 111 At-Tabari 7 :593 121 FathAl-Bari 8:89. 131 Ahmad 3:186.

y » VA WE9 itake a witness in lMr JSCL 4 '3\$' presence;> Allah "-iKt i*' r >" commands the a ' " -r^a>' JtJ*P guardians of orphans to surrender the ,*,- <?-> . .v . f^r.r^ fo"i.-i'A Pro Perty of the ' » «r?*ry> iri J^ orphans who become c°nsentin§ adults, in V the presence of witnesses, so that ,s>i- ^ / ' . s s ^ , < , none of them denies the fact that he the fact that he 4jfrii received his money. ' Allah said next, 'niff \'. 'M. 4*44- i&i ' - iand Am is AU_ '.±M\ "-Sj/io^ Sufficient in taking >.' " - A{.»t k t'y'fr,{. account> mm-v-K Sf,,Z^ ^ Reckoner and L =4 = Watcher over their work for orphans, and when they surrender their money to them, whether their property was complete and whole, or deficient and less. Indeed, Allah knows all of that. In his SahOx, Muslim recorded that the Messenger of Allah% said, 'C^ J* V 'crr^J 4-' ti ill tJ\ Jj ' iSO? JI 3\$ l?{ U» JU 59: v; «0 Abu Dlmrr! Verily, you are weak, and I love for you what I love for myself. Do not become a leader of two nor assume guardianship of an orphan's property, a111 3* A? -ri-4 JyyV5 y'49"l 4/ y »4i JU9i> Muslim 3 : 1458.

terCSi ££&4> ijiji ^ 14^ 'Jt j\ ii ^3/^ ^ ^^ ij& iL ^^&1 S#-V <\$ 4 ©Cwi f} ijSjftj^ ij&£^^ 4 tfft iS a Sj Tref°r men and a share for women from whatA}V Parents and those nearest in relation, whether the property be small or large ~ a legal share.} tstfafZf re'^ md «phm. and me pooronpresent at the time of division, give them from the property and speak to them words of kindness and justice.} P °P ty, tn theirmZdTas thZjZZdZi^fZ^wZ^Zd^efr s°' * >hmhm iio. Verily, those who unjustly eat up the property of orphans, they eat up only a fire into their bellies, and they will be burnt in the blazing Fire!} The

Necessity of Surrendering the Inheritance According to the Portions that Allah Ordained Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said, “The idolaters used to give adult men a share of inheritance and deprive women and children of it. Allah revealed; *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ*” Therefore, everyone is equal in Allah's decision to inherit, even though their shares vary according to the degree of their relationship to the deceased, whether being a relative, spouse, etc. Ibn Marduwyah reported that Jabir said, “Umm Kujjah came to the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* and said to him, ‘O Messenger of Allah! I have two daughters whose father died, and they do not own anything.’ So Allah revealed; *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ*”

Tnkr Ibn Kathir 384_ iV,e,e is a share from what is left by parents and those nearest in relation. We will mention this Hadith when explaining the two Ayat about inheritance. Allah knows best.’ Allah said. *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* those who do not have a share in the inheritance, (and the orphans and the poor), are also *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* dividing the inheritance, give them a share of the inheritance. Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah, *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* —If ‘ *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* And when the relatives mid the orphans and the poor are present at the time of division}, was not abrogated. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that this Ayah still applies and should be implemented . 1 Ath-Thawn said that Ibn Abi Najih narrated from Mujahid that implementing this Ayah, “Is required from those who have anything to inherit paid from whatever portions their hearts are satisfied with giving away.”¹⁵¹ Similar explanation was reported from Ibn Mas‘ud, Abu Musa, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr, Abu Al- ‘Aliyah, Ash-Shabi and Ai-Hasan . Ibn Sinn. Said bin Jubayr, Makhul, Ibrahim An-Nakhal. ‘Ata’ bin Abi Rabah, Az- Zuhri and Yahya bin Ya‘mar said this payment is obligatory. Others say that this refers to the bequeathal at the time of death. And others say that it was abrogated. Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that this Ayah, *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* 111 Abu Dawud 3 :314 . > Path Al-Bari 8 :90 131 At-Tabari 8 :8. 141 At-Tabari 8 :8 151 At-Tabari 8:8. •6| Narrations about the cause of this Ayah’s revelation are not authentic

iAnd when are present at the time of division}, refers to divisions of inheritance. So, when poor relatives, who are ineligible for inheritance, orphans, and the poor attend the division of the inheritance, which is sometimes substantial, their hearts will feel eager to have a share, seeing each eligible person assuming his share; while they are desperate, yet are not given anything. Allah the Most Kind, Most Compassionate, commands that they should have a share in the inheritance as an act of kindness, charity, compassion and mercy for them. Observing Fairness in the Will Allah said, *وَالَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الرَّسُولَ طَائِفَةٌ مِّنْ ذُلِّ الْأُمَمِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُنَّ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ* And let those have the same fear in their minds as they would have for their own, if they had left behind. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that this part of the Ayah, “Refers to a man who is near death and he dictates a will and testament that harms some of the rightful inheritors. Allah commands whoever hears such will to fear Allah, and direct the dying man to do what is right and to be fair, being as eager to protect the inheritors of the dying man as he would be with his own.” * Similar was reported from Mujahid and several others.*² The Two Sahihs record that when the Messenger of Allah visited Sa‘d bin Abi Waqqas during an illness he suffered from, Sa‘d said to the Messenger, “O Messenger of Allah! I am wealthy and have no inheritors except a daughter. Should I give two-thirds of my property in charity?” He said, “No.” Sa‘d asked, “Half?” He said, “No.” Sa‘d said, “One-third?” The Prophet *ﷺ* said; * ‘ > * > fl «One-third, and even one-third is too much. The Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* then said, iJlp ji •ekij’j jji jl ** At-Tabari 8:19. ' At-Jabari 8:21.

387 Siirah 4. An-Nisa (art-4) The people asked, “O Allah’s Messenger! What are they?” He said, J Vj «il fiy>- iJl i4iL d^JjU J I ^ijSj ^3^Jlj , -'l l Jti “To join others in worship along with Allah, magic, to kill the life which Allah has forbidden except for a just cause, to consume interest, to consume an orphan's property, to turn your back to the enemy and flee from the battlefield at the time offighting, and to accuse chaste women who never even think of anything harmful to their chastity being good believers ,»m & '\$4 S&fo & Sk '4 4, Jy tl* ij oils' jjj If; U M ">i 4 3? oU &Sif \$ ^5 !5j i jz J 4 '% \$ \$ & 4>' 'j j' tjr -f>. j; Lr-iil' . UJ* J(7 jif tlii 412 - A//o/j commands you for your children's (inheritance) : to the male, a portion equal to that of two - females; if only daughters, two or more, their share is two thirds of the inheritance; if only one, her share is half. For parents, a sixth share of inheritance to each if the deceased left children; if no children, and the parents are the (only) heirs, the mother has a third; if the deceased left brothers or (sisters), the mother has a sixth. (The distribution in all cases is) after the payment of legacies he may have bequeathed or debts. You know not which of them, whether your parents or your children, are nearest to you in benefit, (these fixed shares) are ordained by Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise. Learning the Various Shares of the Inheritance is Encouraged This, the following, and the last honorable Ayah in this Surah contain the knowledge of Al-Fara'id, inheritance. The knowledge of Al-Fara'id is derived from these three Ayat and Fath Al-Bari 5 :462 , Muslim 1 :92.

388 Tafair Ibn Kathir from the Hadlths on this subject which explain them. Learning this knowledge is encouraged, especially the specific things mentioned in the Ayat. Ibn ‘Uyaynah said; “Knowledge of Al- Fara'id was called half of knowledge, because it effects all people.”

Warning Against Transgressing the Limits for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1093–1120]

Inheritance Meaning, the Fara'id are Allah's set limits. This includes

what Allah has allotted for the heirs, according to the degree of relation they have to the deceased, and their degree of dependency on him. Therefore, do not transgress or violate them. So Allah said; ai' jjai ^ 4And whosoever obeys Allalt and His Messenger,

regarding the inheritance, and does not add or decrease any of these fixed shares by use of tricks and plots. Rather, he gives each his appointed share as Allah commanded, ordained and decided, ' Abu Dawud no. 2870, At-Tirmidhi no. 2121, 2122, An-Nasal no. 3673, Ibn Majah nos. 2712 and 2713.

&y3 Wfe J4i'Sb oj iUJ4> lEi i/ • /,<< >r* *J ^ >> 's?'> \ >" si *' - V-4^ * -ver-Ji All' l_ ^uo ^ ,.' 4: | 4-^ ft iWill be admitted to Cardens under which rivers jlmo (in Paradise), to abide therein, and is the great success. And whosoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, and transgresses His (set) limits. He will cast him into the Fire, to abide therein and he shall have a disgraceful torment This is because he changed what Allah has ordained and disputed with His judgment. Indeed, this is the behavior of those who do not agree with what Allah has decided and divided, and this is why Allah punishes them with humiliation in the eternal, painful torment. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that, the Messenger of Allah jg said, ‘ J tj? «-»!> bli J-*' jSi j)» ' L?es~“ j ^ s>j^ d-Ujj “A man might perform the actions of righteous people for seventy years, but when it is time to compile his will, he commits

injustice. So his final work will be his worst, and he thus enters the Fire. A man might perform the deeds of evil people for seventy years, yet he is fair in his will. So his final work will be his best, and he thus enters Paradise. Abu Hurayrah said, "Read, if you will, these are the limits (set by) Allah until, a disgraceful torment)." 111 In the chapter on injustice in the will, Abu Dawud recorded 111 Ahmad 2:278.

Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "A man or a woman might perform actions in obedience to Allah for sixty years. Yet, when they are near death, they leave an unfair will and thus acquire the Fire." Abu Hurayrah then recited the Ayah, "And after payment of legacies he (or she) may have bequeathed or debts, so that no loss is caused, until the great success." 11 This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi 121 and Ibn Majah, 13' and At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Ghanb". 111 Abu Dawud 3:288. 12 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :304 ' Ibn Majah 2 :902.

And those of your women who commit illegal sexual intercourse, take the evidence of four witnesses from among you against them; and if they testify, confine them (i.e. women) to houses until death comes to them or Allah ordains for them some (other) way." 25. And the two persons among you who commit illegal sexual intercourse, punish them both. And if they repent and do righteous good deeds, leave them alone. Surely, Allah is Ever the One Who accepts repentance, (and He is) Most Merciful. The Adulteress is Confined in her House; A Command Later Abrogated At the beginning of Islam, the ruling was that if a woman commits adultery as stipulated by sufficient proof, she was confined to her home, without leave, until she died. Allah said, "And those of your women who commit illegal sexual intercourse, take the evidence of four witnesses from among you against them; and if they testify, confine them (i.e. women) to houses until death comes to them or Allah ordains for them some (other) way." 'Some other way' mentioned here is the abrogation of this ruling that came later. Ibn 'Abbas said, "The early ruling was confinement, until Allah sent down Surat An-Nur (chapter 24) which abrogated that ruling with the ruling of flogging (for fornication) or stoning to death (for adultery)." Similar was reported from 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam and Ad-Dahhak, and this is a matter that is agreed upon. Imam Ahmad recorded that Tjbadah bin As-Samit said, "When the revelation descended upon the Messenger of Allah it would affect him and his face would show signs of strain.

One day, Allah sent down a revelation to him, and when the Messenger ﷺ was relieved of its strain, he said, "Allah has made some other way for them. The married with the married, the unmarried with the unmarried. The married gets a hundred lashes and stoning to death, while the unmarried gets a hundred lashes then banishment for a year, n" Muslim and the collectors of the Sunan recorded that Tjbadah bin As-Samit said that the Prophet ﷺ said, "Take from me, take from me. Allah has made some other way for them : the (unmarried) gets a hundred lashes and banishment for one year, while the (married)

}So when they saw Our punishment, they said: "We believe in Allah Alone..." (40:84] Allah decided that repentance shall not be accepted from the people of the earth when the sun rises from the west, as Allah said, { *4 V fj. } ili j^ (12 4?) * jl ,53 4T7ie day that some of the signs of your Lord do come, no good will it do to a person to believe then, if he believed not before, nor earned good through his faith.} [6:158]. Allah said, &&& sj %} inor of those who die while they are disbelievers Consequently, when the disbeliever dies while still a disbeliever and polytheist, his sorrow and repentance shall not avail him. If he were to ransom himself, even with the earth's fill of gold, it will not be accepted from him. Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Al-'Aliyah and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said that the Ayah: inor of those who die while they are disbelievers}, was revealed about the people of Shirk. Imam Ahmad recorded that Usamah bin Salman said that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, i vmm a\ spp ^ ' ^ ""ll ~(Jm \ j 1 Ac.

406 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir f*JU — aJLxJ yS*-i aJ—£ Xt*y ^JlSj *1*1 Uj iAllah accepts the repentance of His servant, or forgives His servant, as long as the veil does not dropj They asked, "And what does the drop of the veil mean? " He said, tiSjjJ J&j ^Jil ji» oWhen the soul is removed zohile one is a polythiestV 11 Allah then said, i\J iijcil &£\$} 4For them We have prepared a painful torment}, torment that is severe, eternal and enormous. : t&z % l-fo \yj JPu f \pc t#s> £ i' a. ,y. ' '> , %, T' j' 1s~* j—>«i o' jV-V'* u gjj gjj J ' paj Cji- W2 fr.;^ iiiij i^4J ^ ii* ijllfe *S tjuij ^r'j ^ ^ ^ ^ ^ */< _ - / I I »/ >> ' • S tx y n IUJA oj?*(* 05J ,Aij-AA-'J liiaj j.f.ya jl^=> 1-jJ^ oi U *5/^ <'V< n^O L. 'V>*5oi 4x'5u£i 419. O yoM u»/io believe! You are not permitted to inherit women against their will, nor to prevent them from marriage in order to get part of (the dowry) what you have given them, unless they commit open Fdhishah. And live with them honorably. If you dislike them, it may be that you dislike a thing and Allah brings through it a great deal of good.} 420. But if you intend to replace a wife by another and you have given one of them a Qintar, take not the least bit of it back; would you take it wrongfully without a right and (with) a manifest sin?} 421 . And how could you take it (back) while you have gone in unto each other, and they have taken from you a firm and 111 Ahmad 5:174.

strong covenant?} 422. And marry not women whom your fathers married, except ivhat has already passed; indeed it ivas shameful and Maqtan, and an evil ivay Meaning of 'Inheriting Women Against Their Will' Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said about the Ayah, yj o'jl j_ * V \p\ : Ss# 40 you who believe! You are not permitted to inherit women against their will,} "Before, the practice was that when a man dies, his male relatives used to have the right to do whatever they wanted with his wife. If one of them wants, he would marry her, give her in marriage, or prevent her from marriage, for they had more right to her than her own family. Thereafter, this Ayah was revealed about this practice, & iyj J 40 you who believe! You are not permitted to inherit women against their will}." (11 Women Should not Be Treated with Harshness Allah said, 4nor to prevent them from marriage, in order to take part of what you have given them,} Allah commands: Do not treat the woman harshly so that she gives back all or part of the dowry that she was given, or forfeits one of her rights by means of coercion and oppression. Allah's statement, 4unless they commit open Fdltishah.} Ibn Masrid, Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Ash-Shalai, IM Fath Al-Bari 8 :93 .

Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Muhammad bin Sirin, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Qilabah, Abu Salih, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam and Said bin Abi Hilal said that this refers

to illicit sex. Meaning that if the wife commits adultery, you are allowed to take back the dowry you gave her. You are also allowed to annoy her, until she gives back the dowry in return for a Khula'." (1 * In Surat Al- Baqarah, Allah said, jji. ViJv "J] lili ljjU.tr J llj^ 4And it is not lawful for you (men) to take back (from your wives) any of what you have given them, except when both parties fear that they would be unable to keep the limits ordained by Allti^ [2:229]. Ibn 'Abbas, Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak said that Fahishah refers to disobedience and defiance.*2 ' Ibn Jarir chose the view that it is general, encompasses all these meanings, adultery, disobedience, defiance, rudeness, and so forth. Meaning that he is allowed to annoy his wife when she does any of these acts until she forfeits all or part of her rights and he then separates from her, and this [view] is good, and Allah knows best. Live WithWomen Honorably Allah said, iAnd live with them honorablyK by saying kind words to them, treating them kindly and making your appearance appealing for them, as much as you can, just as you like the same from them. Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd they have rights similar over them to what is reasonable} [2:228]. The Messenger of Allah jg said, m At-Tabari 8:115-117. 121 At-Tabari 8:117.

«ji'v a\j ^ aThe best among you is he ivho is the best with his family. Verily, 1 am the best one among you with myfamily It was the practice of the Messenger of Allah jg to be kind, cheerful, playful with his wives, compassionate, spending on them and laughing with them. The Messenger sg used to race with 'A'ishah, the Mother of the Faithful, as a means of kindness to her. 'A'ishah said, "The Messenger of Allah jg raced with me and I won the race. This occurred before I gained weight, and afterwards I raced with him again, and he won that race. He said, Q eJL&O «77n's [victory] is for that [victory] When the Prophet jg was at the home of one of his wives, sometimes all of his wives would meet there and eat together, and they would then go back to their homes. He and his wife would sleep in the same bed, he would remove his upper garment, sleeping in only his lower garment. The Prophet jg used to talk to the wife whose night it was, after praying 'Isha' and before he went to sleep. Allah said, 4kIL if 4Indeed in the Messenger of Allah you have a good example to follow> [33:21]. Allah said, £ *-iif& ts j ilf you dislike them, it may be that you dislike a thing and Allah brings through it a great deal ofgood. Allah says that your patience, which is demonstrated by keeping wives whom you dislike, carries good rewards for you in this life and the Hereafter. Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, "That the husband may feel compassion towards his wife and Allah gives him a child with her, and this child TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 10 :394 * Abu Dawud 3 :66

carries tremendous goodness." An authentic Hadith states, *44 Cs~fJ > y 1 "No believing man should hale his believing wife. Ifhe dislikes a part ofher conduct, he would surely like another. The Prohibition ofTaking Back the Dowry Allah said, JS jyj j'lj-Li jUjff iBut if you intend to replace a wife by another and you have given one of them a Qintar, take not the least bit of it back; would you take it wrongfully without a right and (with) a manifest sin?} The Ayah commands: When one of you wants to divorce a wife and marry another one, he must not take any portion of the dowry he gave to the first wife, even if it were a Qint&r of money. We mentioned the meaning of Qintar in the Tafsir of Surah Al 'Imran. This Ayah is clear in its indication that the dowry could be substantial. TJmar bin Al-Khattab used to discourage giving a large dowry, but later on changed his view. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Al-'Ajfa' As-Sulami said that he heard TJmar bin Al-Khattab saying, "Do not exaggerate with the dowry ofwomen, had this practice been an honor in this world or a part of Taqwa, then the Prophet is, would have had more right to practice it than you. The Messenger of Allah never gave any of his wives,

nor did any of his daughters receive a dowry more than twelve Uqiyah.*2 A man used to pay a substantial dowry and thus conceal enmity towards his wife!” Ahmad*3 * and the collectors of Sunan collected this Hadith through various chains of narration,*4 * and At-Tirmidhi said, *** Muslim 1 :1091 ’ Approximately 400 Dirhams, refer to the next Hadith Ahmad 1 :40 * This story, and the earlier report from TJmar, were both classified as weak by Muqbil bin Hadi

“Hasan Sahih”. Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that Masruq said, “Umar bin Al- Khattab stood up on the Minbar of the Messenger of Allah jg and said, ‘O people! Why do you exaggerate concerning the dowry given to women? The Messenger of Allah sg and his Companions used to pay up to four hundred Dirhams for a dowry, or less than that. Had paying more for a dowry been a part of Taqwa or an honor, you would not have led them in this practice. Therefore, I do not want to hear about a man who pays more than four hundred Dirhams for a dowry.’ He then went down the Minbar, but a woman from Quraysh said to him, ‘O Leader of the Faithful! You prohibited people from paying more than four hundred Dirhams in a dowry for women?’ He said, ‘Yes.’ She said, ‘Have you not heard what Allah sent down in the Qur’an?’ He said, “Which part of it?’ She said, ‘Have you not heard Allah’s statement, 4}LliS iAntl you have given one of them a Qintdr}?’ He said, ‘O Allah! Forgive me...’ He then went back and stood up on the Minbar saying, ‘I had prohibited you from paying more than four hundred Dirhams in a dowry for women. So, let everyone pay what he likes from his money.’” The chain of narration for this Hadith is strong. 4And how could you take it (back) xohile you have gone in unto each other} how can you take back the dowry from the woman with whom you had sexual relations and she had sexual relations with you? Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddi and several others said that this means sexual intercourse.12 * The Two Sahihs record that the Messenger of Allah jg said three times to the spouses who said the Mula’annah; ** Abu Dawud 2:582, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :255 , An-Nasal 6:117, Ibn Majah 1 :601 |2! At-Tabari 8:126. * Refer to Surat An-Nur 24 :6-9

UsS* lysis' us}L^f ji Jilin *Allah knows that one of you is a liar, so would any of you repent? » The man said, “O Messenger of Allah! My money,” referring to the dowry that he gave his wife. The Messenger said. ji tfcl* JUS jj tJjU Jli »I& ill i~f& IfcU «Yom have no money. Ifyou are the one who said the truth, the dowry is in return far the right to have sexual intercourse with her. Ifyou are the one who uttered the lie, then this money is even fartherfrom your reachJ Similarly Allah said; Ji fAsxiin && jij iAnd how could you take it (back) while you have gotie in unto each other and they have taken from uou a firm and strong covenant)> this refers to the marriage tie, according to Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr . In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Jabir said that during the speech that the Prophet jg gave in the Farewell Hajj, he said, >4)1 ii!S3 4)1jut i I fr*- »LUL I «Be kind with women, far you have taken them by Allah's covenant and earned the right to have sexual relations with them by Allah's Word. »,3) Marrying the Wife ofthe Father is Prohibited Allah said, iAnd marry not women whom yourfathers married Path Al-B&ri 9 :366 and Muslim 2:1131. l2) At-Tabari 8 :129 131 MusUm 2:889.

Allah prohibits marrying the women whom the father married, in honor and respect to the fathers, not allowing their children to have sexual relations with their wives after they die. A woman becomes ineligible for the son of her husband as soon as the marriage contract is conducted, and there is a consensus on this ruling. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to prohibit what Allah prohibits (concerning marriage), except marrying the stepmother and

taking two sisters as rival wives. Allah sent down, *And marry not women whom your fathers married, and two sisters in wedlock at the same time* [4:23].” 111 Similar was reported from ‘Ata’ and Qatadah. Therefore, the practice that the Ayah mentions is prohibited for this Ummah, being disgraced as an awful sin, *Indeed it was shameful and Maqtan, and an evil way.* Allah said in other Ayat, *Come not near to Al-Fawdhish (shameful acts) whether committed openly or secretly* [6:151], and, *And come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is a Fdliishah and an evil way.* [17:32] In this Ayah (4:22), Allah added, *and Maqtan*, meaning, offensive. It is a sin itself and causes the son to hate his father after he marries his wife. It is usual 111 At-Tabari 8:132. 121 At-Tabari 8 :132-134.

that whoever marries a woman dislikes those who married her before him. This is one reason why the Mothers of the Faithful were not allowed for anyone in marriage after the Messenger. They are indeed the Mothers of the Faithful since they married the Messenger, who is like the father to the believers. Rather, the Prophet’s right is far greater than the right of a father, and his love comes before each person loving himself, may Allah’s peace and blessings be on him. ‘Ata’ bin Abi Rabah said that the Ayah, *and Maqtan*, means, Allah will hate him, *it is an evil way*, for those who take this way. Therefore, those who commit this practice will have committed an act of reversion from the religion and deserve capital punishment and confiscation of their property, which will be given to the Muslim Treasury. Imam Ahmad and the collectors of Sunan recorded that Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib said that his uncle Abu Burdah was sent by the Messenger of Allah to a man who married his stepmother to execute him and confiscate his money. 111 -jjt u£ 5-fj 4 4\$ It UftM3^ *3 4> efj[JiiH. jS C 'Jj 423. Forbidden to you (for marriage) are: your mothers, your daughters, your sisters, your father's sisters, your mother's sisters, your brother's daughters, your sister's daughters, your foster mothers who suckled you, your foster milk suckling sisters, your wives' mothers, your stepdaughters under your Ahmad 4:290, Abu Dawud 4:609, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:598, An-Nasat in Ai-Kubrd 4 :296, Ibn Majah 2 :869.

guardianship, *from your wives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them (to marry their daughters), - the wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins, and two sisters in wedlock at the same time, except for what has already passed; verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.* Degrees of Women Never Eligible for One to Marry This honorable Ayah is the Ayah that establishes the degrees of women relatives who are never eligible for one to marry, because of blood relations, relations established by suckling or marriage. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “(Allah said) I have prohibited for you seven types of relatives by blood and seven by marriage.” Ibn ‘Abbas then recited the Ayah, *Forbidden to you (for marriage) are: your mothers, your daughters, your sisters .. ,* } ll] At-Tabari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Seven degrees of blood relation and seven degrees of marriage relation are prohibited (for marriage).” He then recited the Ayah, *Forbidden to you (for marriage) are: your mothers, your daughters, your sisters, your father’s sisters, your mother’s sisters, your brother's daughters, your sister's daughters* } and these are the types prohibited by blood relation. Allah’s statement, *Your foster mothers who suckled you, your foster milk suckling sisters* } At-Jabari 8 :142 121 At-Jabari 8:141.

means, just as your mother who bore you is prohibited for you in marriage, so is your mother from suckling prohibited for you. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that ‘A’ishah, the Mother of the Faithful, said that the Messenger of Allah, *WjJl (* U J ji*» “Suckling prohibits what birth prohibits .» In

another narration reported by Muslim, “Suckling establishes prohibited degrees just as blood does . ‘Suckling’ that Establishes Prohibition for Marriage Less than Five incidents of suckling will not establish prohibition for marriage. In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “Among the parts of the Qur’an that were revealed, is the statement, ‘Ten incidents of suckling establishes the prohibition (concerning marriage).’ It was later abrogated with five, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ died while this statement was still recited as part of the Qur’an.” 121 A Hadith that Sahlah bint Suhayl narrated states that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ordered her to suckle Salim the freed slave of Abu Hudhayfah with five.” 3) We should assert that the suckling mentioned here must occur before the age of two, as we stated when we explained the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَنْكِحُوا مَا كَانُوا آبَاءَكُمْ بِأَسْنَانِكُمْ وَلَوْلَا فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ فَكُنْتُمْ آبَاءَهُمْ عَادَةً مِّنَ الدُّنْيَا وَاللَّهُ عَظِيمٌ 4(The mothers) should suckle their children for two whole years, (that is) for those (parents) who desire to complete the term of suckling (2:233], ^ Fath Al-Bari 9 :43 and Muslim 2 :1068 Muslim 2:1075. ' Abu Dawud 2 :550.

The Mother-in-Law and Stepdaughter are Prohibited in Marriage Allah said next, يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَنْكِحُوا مَا كَانُوا آبَاءَكُمْ بِأَسْنَانِكُمْ وَلَوْلَا فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ فَكُنْتُمْ آبَاءَهُمْ عَادَةً مِّنَ الدُّنْيَا وَاللَّهُ عَظِيمٌ 4Your wives’ mothers, your stepdaughters under your guardianship, born of your wives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them,} As for the mother of the wife, she becomes prohibited for marriage for her son-in-law when the marriage is conducted, whether the son-in-law has sexual relations with her daughter or not. As for the wife’s daughter, she becomes prohibited for her stepfather when he has sexual relations with her mother, after the marriage contract is ratified. If the man divorces the mother before having sexual relations with her, he is allowed to marry her daughter. So Allah said; يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَنْكِحُوا مَا كَانُوا آبَاءَكُمْ بِأَسْنَانِكُمْ وَلَوْلَا فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ فَكُنْتُمْ آبَاءَهُمْ عَادَةً مِّنَ الدُّنْيَا وَاللَّهُ عَظِيمٌ 4Your stepdaughters under your guardianship, born of your wives unto whom you have gone in - but there is no sin on you if you have not gone in unto them,} to marry the stepdaughter. The Stepdaughter is Prohibited in Marriage Even if She Was Not Under the Guardianship of Her Stepfather Allah said, 44^ your stepdaughters under your guardianship,} The majority of scholars state that the stepdaughter is prohibited in marriage for her stepfather [who consummated his marriage to her mother] whether she was under his guardianship or not. The Two Sahih recorded that Umm Hablah said, “O Messenger of Allah! Marry my sister, the daughter of Abu Sufyan (and in one narration ‘Azzah bint Abu Sufyan).” He said,

418 Tafsir Ibtisam Katheer ج ٤ ١٤٣٦ ب ١٢٧١ س ٢٢١ ج ١ - ٥٢٠ < * i h i O w i > o U U : o J l i • ^ J j > v » w J L J i > O ^ i i j f t 1 o J \ j C J j P ! i j l j 4 * O k _ L - l f c 4 - j y < * J L * U l j j \ J j f u r ^ v — ^ 1 * • ^ l * ^ j ^ k > - “ ^ y S v ^ 9 ” ^ J Z f * i r « "Do you like that I do that?" She said, "I would not give you up for anything, but the best of whom I like to share with me in that which is righteously good, is my sister." He said, "That is not allowed for me." She said, "We were told that you want to marry the daughter of Abu Salamah." He asked, "The daughter of Umm Salamah?" She said, "Yes." He said, "Even if she was not my stepdaughter and under my guardianship, she is still not allowed for me because she is my niece from suckling, for Thuwaybah suckled me and Abu Salamah. Therefore, do not offer me to marry your daughters or sisters."® In another narration from Al-Bukhari, ر ٢٠٠٠ ^ ٧١١٧ هـ I not married Umm Salamah, her daughter would not have been allowed for me anyway ٧٢١ Consequently, the Messenger ﷺ stated that his marriage to Umm Salamah was the real reason behind that prohibition. Meaning of ‘gone in unto them’ The Ayah continues, 4 Sit 4 Your wives unto whom you have gone in }, meaning, had sexual relations with them, according to Ibn ‘Abbas and several others. 131 Prohibiting the Daughter-in-Law for Marriage Allah said, ١١ ' Path Al-Bari 9 :64 and Muslim 2 :1073 Fath Al-Bdri 9:62. 131 At-Jabari 8:148.

CJi iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} Therefore, you are prohibited to marry the wives of your own sons, but not the wives of your adopted sons, as adoption was common practice in JdhiUyyah. Allah said, & a \$& * & <&& ss ft 3:5^ 4So when Zayd had accomplished his desire from her (i.e. divorced her), We gave her to you in marriage, so that (in future) there may be no difficulty to the believers in respect of (the marriage of) the wives of their adopted sons when the latter have no desire to keep them (i.e. they had divorced them).} [33:37] Ibn Jurayj said, "I asked 'Ata' about Allah's statement, iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} He said, "We were told that when the Prophet jg married the ex-wife of Zayd (who was the Prophet's adopted son before Islam prohibited this practice), the idolators in Makkah criticized him. Allah sent down the Ayat I# iThe wives of your sons who (spring) from your own loins,} ipti) pZTl Cj} inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} [33:4], and, ipCj 6sA ^ 'j? £} iMuhammad is not the father of any of your men} [33:40], ""{11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Hasan bin Muhammad said, "These Ayat are encompassing, IM At-Tabari 8 :149.

4the wives of your sons}, and, iyour wives' mothers}. This is also the explanation of Tawus, Ibrahim, Az-Zuhri and Makhul. It means that these two Aydt encompass these types of women, whether the marriage was consummated or not, and there is a consensus on this ruling. A Doubt and Rebuttal Why is the wife of one's son from suckling prohibited for him for marriage - that is, if she is no longer married to his son from suckling - as the majority of scholars state, although they are not related by blood? The answer is the Prophet's statement, «Suckling prohibits what blood relations prohibit. n* 1 The Prohibition of Taking Two Sisters as Rival Wives Allah said, 3 C -ft ^ & } hi Muslim 2 :1072.

4...and two sisters in wedlock at the same time, except for what has already passed The Ayah commands: you are prohibited to take two sisters as rival wives, or riveil female-servants, except for what had happened to you during the time of Jahiliyyah, which We have forgiven and erased. Therefore, no one is allowed to take or keep two sisters as rival wives, according to the consensus of the scholars of the Companions, their followers, and the Imams of old and present. They all stated that taking two sisters as rival wives is prohibited, and that whoever embraces Islam while married to two sisters at the same time is given the choice to keep one of them and divorce the other. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ad-Dahhak bin Fayruz said that his father said, "I embraced Islam while married to two sisters at the same time and the Prophet 3^ commanded me to divorce one of them." 111 424. Also (forbidden are) women already married, except those (slaves) whom your right hands possess. Thus has Allah ordained for you . All others are lawful, provided you seek them (with a dowry) from your property, desiring chastity, not fornication. So with those among them whom you have enjoyed, give them their required due, but if you agree mutually (to give more) after the requirement (has been determined), there is no sin on you. Surely, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise. Forbidding Women Already Married, Except for Female Slaves Allah said, [ii Ahmad 4 :232

422 Tafsir Ibn Kathfr 4Also (forbidden are) women already married, except those whom your right hands possess.} The Ayah means, you are prohibited from marrying women who are already married, iexcept those whom your right hands possess} except those whom you acquire through war, for you are allowed such women after making sure they are not pregnant. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said, "We captured some women from the area of Awtas who were already married, and we

disliked having sexual relations with them because they already had husbands. So, we asked the Prophet ﷺ about this matter, and this Ayah was revealed, && C\ CQl Sj iAlso (forbidden are) women already married, except those whom your right hands possess}. Consequently, we had sexual relations with these women.” This is the wording collected by At-Tirmidhi*2 * An-Nasa’i,*3 Ibn Jarir*4 and Muslim in his Soth.*5 Allah’s statement, *1 *” fit Oil k—IX iThus has Allah ordained for you} means, this prohibition was ordained for you by Allah. Therefore, adhere to Allah’s Book, do not transgress His set limits, and adhere to His legislation and decrees. The Permission toMany All OtherWomen Allah said, 111 Ahmad 3:72 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 4 :282 * An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubra 3 :308 * At-Tabari 8:153 ' Muslim 2:1080

iAU others are lawful^ meaning, you are allowed to marry women other than the prohibited types mentioned here, as ‘Ata’ and others have stated. Allah’s statement, j’.Ct Jf. \$} iprovided you seek them (with a dowry) from your property, desiring chastity, notfornication,\$ meaning, you are allowed to use your money to marry up to four wives and for (the purchase of) as many female slaves as you like, all through legal means, i(desiring) chastity, notfornication .} Allah’s statement, (jf-J u»f 4So zvith those among them whom you have enjoyed, give them their required due,} means, to enjoy them sexually, surrender to them their rightful dowry as compensation. In other Ayat, Allah said, 4And how could you take it (back) while you have gone in unto each other}, \yC3} 4And give to the women (whom you marry) their dowry with a good heart}, and, 0^5j CU o' 'jj} 4And it is not lawful for you (men) to take back (from your wives) any ofwhat (dowry) you gave them} Prohibiting the Mut’ah ofMarriage Mujahid stated that, e . y-£ z> >.s< c>• >«*•' *f in-t *.* Uif At-Tabari 8 : 172

424 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iSo with those among them whom you have enjoyed, give them their required due,} was revealed about the Mut'ah marriage. A Mut'ah marriage is a marriage that ends upon a predetermined date. In the Two Sahths, it is recorded that the Leader of the Faithful ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ prohibited Mut'ah marriage and eating the meat of domesticated donkeys on the day of Khaybar (battle).”²¹ In addition, in his Sahth, Muslim recorded that Ar-Rabl‘ bin Sabrah bin Ma*bad Al-Juhani said that his father said that he accompanied the Messenger of Allah during the conquest of Makkah, and that the Prophet ﷺ said, 'fa ji Sil ^ ^l£4iVl J jlid JJii sils Jl [£\ u« il<)jj iaL-- jfa i t si 11211 cj «iLi “O people! / allowed you the Mut'ah marriage with women before. Noiv, Allah has prohibited it until the Day of Resurrection. Therefore, anyone who has any women in Mut'ah, let him let them go, and do not take anything from what you have given them .»|31 Allah’s statement, {far *3j} ibut ifyou agree mutually (to give more) after the requirement (has been determined), there is no sin on you.} is similar to His other statement, fell! iy\lj} iAnd give to the zoomen their dozory zoith a good heart}.

The meaning of these Ayat is: Ifyou have stipulated a dowry

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1120–1131]

for her, and she later forfeits it, either totally or partially, then this bears no harm on you or her in this case. Ibn Jarir said, “Al-Hadrami said that some men would designate a certain dowry, but then fall into financial difficulties. Therefore, Allah At-Jabari 8:176 Fath Al-Bari9 :590 , Muslim 2 :1027 Muslim 2:1025

said that there is no harm on you, O people, concerning your mutual agreement after the requirement (has been determined).”¹¹¹ meaning, if she gives up part of the dowry, then you men are allowed to accept that. Allah’s statement, *‘Lic oS* ii’ 4Surely, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise is suitable here, after Allah mentioned these prohibitions. 0% U Ja*> jj pCifJ IjSj oijjLS’ Ji i p.< 1 .”A . <* . ’> . t~\~! <>*~\ 0}* \ XkJaA JJ mA j\c- tyrfbA *J cElt ^ ^ .;AS3t ^ 4t.ss*£e5 *y* jst ot> 425 . And whoever ofyou have not the means wherewith to wed free believing women, they may wed believing girlsfrom among those whom your right hands possess, and Allah has full knowledge about your faith, you are one from another. Wed them with the permission of their own folk (guardians) and give them their due in a good manner; they should be chaste, not fornicators, nor promiscuous. And after they have been taken in wedlock, if they commit Fdliishah, their punishment is half that for free (unmarried) women . This is for him among you who is afraid of being harmed in his religion or in his body; but it is better for you that you practice self-restraint, and Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Marrying a Female Slave, if One Cannot Marry a Free Woman Allah said, those who do not have, 4the means), financial capability, 4Wherewith to wedfree believing women) m At-Tabari 8 :180*

meaning, free faithful, chaste women. *ui <^2i^ c5Cju U iThey may wed believing girls from among those whom your right hands possess,} meaning, they are allowed to wed believing slave girls[1] owned by the believers. iand Allah has full knowledge about your faith; you are one from another.} Allah knows the true reality and secrets of all things, but you people know only the apparent things. Allah then said. iWed them with the permission of their own folk indicating that the owner is responsible for the slave girl, and consequently, she cannot marry without his permission. The owner is also responsible for his male slave and they cannot wed without his permission. A Hadith states, ®j (jyt ^yy^J. lbl> «Any male slave who marries without permission from his master, is a fornicator.»|21 When the owner of the female slave is a female, those who are allowed to give away the free woman in marriage, with her permission, become responsible for giving away her female slave in marriage, as well. A Hadith states that «77ie woman does not give away another woman, or herself in marriage, for only the adulteress gives herself away in marriage. »|31 Allah’s statement, Recently converted captives ofwar. 121 Abu Dawud 2 :563 Ibn Majah 1 :606*

427Surah 4. An-Nisa (Part-5) *iAttd give them their due in a good manner;} meaning, pay them their dowry with a good heart, and do not keep any of it, belittling the matter due to the fact that they are owned slaves. Allah’s statement, i^cJ^} ithey should be chaste^ means, they are honorable women who do not commit adultery, and this is why Allah said, 4not fornicators} referring to dishonorable women, who do not refrain from illicit sexual relations with those who ask. Ibn ‘Abbas said that the fornicating women are the whores, who do not object to having relations with whomever seeks it, while, u.1 %} inor promiscuous.} refers to taking boyfriends. ' Similar was said by Abu Hurayrah, Mujahid, Ash-Shalsi, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Yahya bin Abi Kathir, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As-Suddi.’2 ' The Slave Girl’s Punishment for Adultery is Halfthat of a Free UnmarriedWoman Allah said, # / j *i <*/ / \ iAnd after they have been taken in wedlock, if they commit Fdhishah, their punishment is half of that for free (unmarried) women.} this is about the slave women who got married, as indicated by the Ayah; p£3i»j1 cSIU ! ^*1 J fyd. Ij ^ iAf} iAnd whoever ofyou have not the means wherewith to wed free believing women, they may wed believing girls from among 111 At-Tabari 8 :193 121 At-Jabari 8:194*

lr^ zwm AV 8SW3 J"J C, XjfoSj t iJLiJo^JjT ^ IL-»-j o^ui '5[ij^optafe; \a-j j^j«^l>l^s=»^olf^~vaS^ 4jj\ i sfMW '*4lh'-^~j<4v J^=<4.j^ li—ic. those whom your right hands possess,> Therefore, since the honorable Ayah is about believing slave girls, then, il^A%} }And after they have been taken in wedlock, } refers to when they (believing slave girls) get married, as Ibn ‘Abbas and others have said. 11 ' Allah’s statement, CfCkMS\ J* U » -*jfe iUiar 4their punishment is half of that for free (un-married) women.> indicates that the type of punishment prescribed here is the one that can be reduced to half, lashes in this case, not stoning to death, and Allah knows best. Allah’s statement, oxji oA 4This is for him among you who is afraid of being harmed in his religion or in his body;} indicates that marrying slave girls, providing one satisfies the required conditions, is for those who fear for their chastity and find it hard to be patient and refrain from sex. In this difficult circumstance, one is allowed to marry a slave girl. However, it is better to refrain from marrying slave girls and to observe m At-Tabari 8 :202

patience, for otherwise, the offspring will become slaves to the girl’s master. Allah said, < »>.< .t'ko'jf ibut it is better for you that you practice self-restraint, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 14 tg; pe-g j. pbtizP cs'A & + *4 " > ** A? > >' *>- <' '\ » t'fJLj^ Aji\ « .**->?*J* y^_ j' *a'j .r / / y. | X ^ »>y* y /'i f » I .^1,./ . ^ ^ ,^v p^o-c- o' ;ivyU-kc. ^26. A//fl/j wishes to make clear (what is lawful and what is unlawful) to you, and to show you the ways of those before you, and accept your repentance, and Allah is All-Knower, All- Wise. 427. Allah wishes to accept your repentance, but those who follow their lusts, wish that you (believers) should deviate tremendously away (from the right path)} 428. Allah wishes to lighten (the burden) for you; and man was created weak.} Allah explains to the believers what He has allowed and prohibited for them in this and other Surahs, 4And to show you the ways of those before you,} meaning their righteous ways and how to adhere to the commandments that He likes and is pleased with. 4and accept your repentance} from sin and error, 41&. 14%} 4and Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.} in His commands, decrees, actions and statements. Allah’s statement, 4d_Ur. [Pi J 4but those who follow their lusts, wish that you (believers) should deviate tremendously awayfrom the right path)}

indicates that the followers of Shaytan among the Jews, Christians and the adulterous, wish that you would take the horrendous path of falsehood instead of the truth. 4^ J& iAllah wishes to lighten (the burden) for you"} His legislation, orders, what He prohibits and what He decrees for you. This is why Allah has allowed free men to marry slave girls under certain conditions, as Mujahid and others have stated. 4and man was created weak.} and this is why it is suitable in his case that the commands are made easy for him, because of his weakness and feebleness. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Tawus said that, gy# &•,} iand man was created iveak}, “Concerning women”.121 Wakf said, “Man’s mind leaves when women are involved.” ^ oi Vi \-fkJ6 v \frX jli . lii yj Jf"} 0 ‘*r Jc —‘-ii'i Ijt Lj'jjii 4±tL.? &S £ yCk=, 429. O you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly except it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent. And do not kill yourselves (nor kill one another). Surely, Allah is Most Merciful to you.} 430. And whoever commits that through aggression and injustice, We shall cast him into the Fire, and that is easy for Allah.} 431. Ifyou avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do. We shall remit from you your (small) sins, and admit you to a At-Jabari 8:215 At-Tabari 8:216

Noble Entrance (i.e. Paradise).} Prohibiting Unlawfully Banned Money Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, prohibits His believing servants from illegally acquiring each other's property using various dishonest methods such as Riba, gambling and other wicked methods that appear to be legal, but Allah knows that, in reality, those involved seek to deal in interest. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented on a man who buys a garment, saying that if he likes it he will keep it, or he will return it along with an extra Dirham, "This is what Allah meant, when He said, Qfc %} iEat not up your property among yourselves unjustly." }^ 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When Allah sent down, V \ \$x \$£> }0 you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly} some Muslims said, 'Allah has forbidden us from eating up each other's property unjustly, and food is our best property. Therefore, none among us is allowed to eat from anyone else's food.' After that Allah sent down, iThere is no restriction on the blind} (until the end of the Ayah). (24:61]." Qatadah said similarly. Allah's statement, oj?y o iexcept it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent.} means, do not revert to illegal ways and means to acquire money. However, there is no harm in commercial transactions that transpire between the buyer and the seller with mutual consent, so that money is legally earned from these in At-Tabari 8 :217

transactions. Mujahid said that, 4except it be a trade amongst you, by mutual consent . \$> means, "By selling and buying, or giving someone a gift." Ibn Jarir recorded this statement. The Option to Buy or Sell Before Parting, is Part of 'Mutual Consent' in Trading Mutual agreement in various transactions is attained when both parties have the right to uphold or dissolve the agreement before they part. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, juu judu "The seller and the buyer retain the (right to change their mind) as long as they have not parted.»12 ' Al-Bukhari's wording for this Hadxth reads, *1Tj&i (Jt* Jlj lijs oWhen two men conduct a transaction, they retain their (right to change their mind) as long as they have not parted . Forbidding Murder and Suicide Allah said, ip&\$2& 4And do not kill yourselves.^ by committing Allah's prohibitions, falling into sin and eating up each other's property unjustly, iSurely, Allah is Most Merciful to you.\$ in what He commanded you and prohibited you from. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amr bin Al-'As said that when At-Jabari 8:221 Fath Al-Bari 4 :385 , Muslim 3 : 1 163 Fath Al-Bari 4 :390

the Prophet jg sent him for the battle ofDhat As-Salasil, "I had a wet dream during a very cold night and feared that if I bathed, I would die. So I performed Tayammum (with pure earth) and led my company in the Dawn prayer. When I went back to the Messenger of Allah jg, 1 mentioned what had happened to me and he said, c-jij JLUvJsL olijff !jfLZ- «0 'Amr! Have you led your people in prayer while you were in a state ofsexual impurity?» I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! I had a wet dream on a very cold night and feared that if I bathed I would perish, and I remembered Allah's statement, iAnd do not kill yourselves. Surely, Allah is Most Merciful to you>. So I performed Tayammum and prayed.' The Messenger of Allah sg smiled and did not say anything." This is the narration reported by Abu Dawud. Ibn Marduwyah mentioned this honorable Ayah and then reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah S& said, fc f—irT ^ V. <liaj tjj i oJj ^ 4 ji) 1 t ^ < #Jj aI . j IjLUv4 ' ^ i lif iJIL* ijJu. 8 tjbl lx-j IjiL. IjJl^> «Whoever kills himself with an iron tool, then his tool will be in his hand and he will keep stabbing himselfwith it in the Fire of Jahannam, forever and ever. Whoever kills himself with poison, then his poison will be in his hand and he will keep taking it in the Fire of Jahannam forever and ever. Wlwever kills himself by throwing himselffrom a mountain, will keep falling in the Fire

of Jahannam forever and ever.» This Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahihs. Abu Qilabah said that Thabit bin Ad-Dahhak said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said,

434 Tafstr Ibn Kathfr (Ji V-'JL* 'j/j-i-; ,i “W/ioraer Ar/7/s himself with an instrument, will be punished with it on the Day of Resurrection . This Hadith was collected by the Group. This is why Allah said, li'jii Jliji JliT J^j} iAnd whoever commits that through aggression and injustice, ^ meaning, whoever commits what Allah has forbidden for him transgression and injustice - while knowing that it is forbidden for him, yet he still dares to commit it, AWe shall cast him into the Fire,}. This Ayah carries a stern warning and a truthful promise. Therefore, every sane person should beware of it, those who hear the speech with full comprehension. Minor Sins Willbe Pardoned ifOne Refrains from Major Sins Allah said. 4f Oyj* & ilfyou avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do, We shall remitfrom you your (small) sins,} meaning, if you avoid the major evil deeds that you were prohibited We will forgive you the minor evil deeds and will admit you into Paradise. This is why Allah said. iand admit you to a Noble Entrance (i.e. Paradise).} There are several Hadlths on the subject of this honorable Ayah. Imam Ahmad recorded that Salman Al-Farisi said, “The Prophet ﷺ said to me, ‘Do you know what the day of Al- Jumu'ah is?’ I said, It is the day during which Allah brought together the creation ofyour father (Adam).’ He said. A J>A' '4^i ^ U

t<LUl U <J Sjlls jls «/ know what the day of Jumu'ah is. Anyone who takes a bath and cleans himself as much as he can and then proceeds for the Friday prayer and remains quiet until the Imam finishes the prayer, all his sins in between the present and the next Friday will be forgiven, as long as major sins were avoided . Al-Bukhari recorded similar wording from Salman Al-Farisi. The Seven Destructive Sins

What are the Seven Destructive Sins?

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1131–1171]

In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, «Avoid the seven great destructive sins.® The people inquired, 'O Allah's Messenger! What are they?' He said. ojij j i ;,,H Jli “To join others in worship along with Allah, to kill the life which Allah has forbidden except for a just cause, magic, to consume Riba, to consume an orphan's wealth, to turn aioay from the enemy and flee from the battlefield when the battle begins, and to accuse chaste women, who never even think of anything that would tarnish their chastity and are good believers, n 1 ' 1 Another Hadith that mentions False Witness Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ mentioned the major sins, or was asked about the major sins. He said, •jiuiijii j&j ijuL Fath Al-Bari 5 : 462 , Muslim 1 :92

437Surah 4. An-Nisa' (Part-5) “To make a rivalfor Allah while He Alone created yo«.» I said, Then?' He said, ^ iljJj 01® “To kill your offspring far fear that he might share your food with youJ I said, Then?' He said, «i5jU- iLii- 01 •To commit adultery with your neighbor's wifeV * He then recited, 4>-* ^ v u&j} iAnd those who invoke not any other god along with Allah}, until, * vi} iExcept those who repent} Another Hadith from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that the Prophet said, - duJi j-i j} ijiu ili^i 'js\i The greatest sins are: To join others in worship with

Allah, to be undutiful to one's parents - or to take a life» Shubah was uncertain of which one - «and the false oath Recorded by Al-Bukhari, At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasai. Another Hadith by 'Abdullah bin 'Amr about Causing one's Parents to be Cursed 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that the Messenger of Allah sfe said, •jJjJij oi fs\ ly. op FathAl-Bari 8:350, Muslim 1 :90 Al-Bukhari 6675, Tuhfat At-Ahwadhi3021 and An-Nasal 8 :63

438 Tafsir Ibti Kathir vAmong the worst of the major sins is for a man to curse his own parents .» They said, “How can one curse his own parents?” He said, dJJj »;d d jfp “One curses another man's father, and that man curses his father in retaliation, or he curses someone's mother and that man curses his mother . This is the wording of Muslim. 111 At-Tirmidhi said, “Sahih.” It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jg said, «Cursing a Muslim is a sin andfighting him is Kufr .»|21 *A.._y4j jy-yi »> ,a* u ^ v* v^^ 4.r.' . tC-lc *. <ii os— 4*^ 432. And wish not for the things in which Allah has made some ofyou to excel others. For men there is reward for what they have earned, (and likezwise) for ivomen there is reward for what they have earned, and ask Allah of His bounty. Surely, Allah is Ever All-Knower ofeverything> Do NotWish for the Things Which Allah hasMadeSome Others to Excel In Imam Ahmad recorded that Umm Salamah said, “O Messenger of Allah! Men go to battle, but we do not go to battle, and we earn one-half of the inheritance (that men get).” Allah sent down, iAnd wish not for the things in which Allah has made some of you to excel others^. At-Tirmidhi also recorded this HadithJ 41 Allah’s statement, Muslim no . 90 Al-Bukhari : 5973, Muslim : 64 131 Ahmad 6 :322 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :375 , 377

** JE»> 4For mett there is reward for what they have earned, (and likewise) for women there is reiuard for what they have earned, £ indicates, according to Ibn Jarir, that each person will earn his wages for his works, a reward if his deeds are good, and punishment if his deeds are evil. It was also reported that this Ayah is talking about inheritance, indicating the fact that each person will get his due share of the inheritance, as Al-Walibi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas. Allah then directed the servants to what benefits them, ot Vi' iand ask Allah of His Bounty.^Therefore, the Ayah states, “Do not wish for what other people were endowed with over you, for this is a decision that will come to pass, and wishing does not change its decree. However, ask Me ofMy favor and I will grant it to you, for I Am Most Generous and Most Giving.” Allah then said, iSurely, Allah is Ever All-Knower ofeverything.} meaning, Allah knows who deserves this life, and so He gives him riches, and whoever deserves poverty, He makes him poor. He also knows who deserves the Hereafter, and He directs him to perform the deeds that will help him to be sucessful in it, and whoever deserves failure, He prevents him from achieving righteousness and what leads to it. Hence, Allah said, iZr ft '-if iSurely, Allah is Ever All-Knower ofeverything} Ooix- .jOii'S 'iSj'jiV'j Jlj ^ 433. And to everyone, We have appointed Mawali of that left by parents and relatives. To those also with whom you have ‘Ali bin Abi Jalhah

made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion (by wills). Truly, Allah is Ever a Witness over all things.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam, As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan, and others said that Allah’s statement, iAnd to everyone, We have appointed Mawali} means, “Heirs.” * Ibn ‘Abbas was also reported to have said that Mawali refers to relatives. Ibn Jarir commented, “The Arabs call the cousin a Mawla.” Ibn Jarir continued, “Allah’s statement, iof that (property) left by parents and relatives.} means, from what he inherited from his

parents and family members. Therefore, the meaning of the Ayah becomes: To all of you, O people, We appointed relatives (such as children) who will later inherit what you inherited from your own parents and relatives.” Allah’s statement, *To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion* .} means, “Those with whom you have a pledge of brotherhood, give them their share of inheritance, thus fulfilling the ratified pledges that you gave them. Allah has witnessed all of you when you gave these pledges and promises.” This practice was followed in the beginning of Islam, but was later on abrogated when Muslims were commanded to fulfill the pledges (brotherhood) they had already given, but to refrain from making any new pledges after that. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, *And to everyone, We have appointed Mawali* “meaning, heirs; *m At-Jabari 8 :270-271*

To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood) \$ When the emigrants came to Al-Madinah, the emigrant would inherit from the Ansari, while the latter’s relatives would not inherit from him because of the bond of brotherhood which the Prophet ﷺ established between them (the emigrants and the Ansar). When the verse, *And to everyone We have appointed Mawdli* ^ was revealed, it cancelled (the pledge of brotherhood regarding inheritance).” Then he said, “The verse, *aagis&s At iSStga s- » < . . ^ } - ' <14 t •<> > > >-(.< s'*.# < >>\ " < A< -tf Is* 4 -r As*.*.' ij[jj 1EJ ' 2 Cjtf<1)1^= .-T tfe'-. '*i<// . t. a - .>1." .>, >s.\ * -i' -• ?' (, p-ayli* p<-=i »l >->Aac- o-jH* *To those also with whom you have made a pledge (brotherhood), give them their due portion.* remained valid for cases of co-operation and mutual advice, while the matter of inheritance was excluded and it became permissible to assign something in one’s will to the person who had the right of inheriting before.” *m Fath. Al-Bari 8 :96*

&& &&& & iii tL ^4 liji i^l5 **£1 O^6 b** \$ 0j» l^j^j 4Si 434. Men are the protectors and maintainers of women, because Allah has made one of them to excel the other, and because they spend (to support them) from their means. Therefore the righteous women are Qanitat, and guard in the husband's absence what Allah orders them to guard. As to those women on whose part you see ill conduct, admonish them, and abandon them in their beds, and beat them, but if they return to obedience, do not seek a means against them. Surely, Allah is Ever Most High, Most Create Allah said, if \$ iMen are the protectors and maintainers of women,} meaning, the man is responsible for the woman, and he is her maintainer, caretaker and leader who disciplines her if she deviates. 4because Allah has made one of them to excel the other,} meaning, because men excel over women and are better than them for certain tasks. This is why prophethood was exclusive of men, as well as other important positions of leadership. The Prophet said, *pp tjJJ fji £4^ jJ» «People who appoint a woman to be their leader, will never achieve success .»* Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadlth) 1] Such is the case with appointing women as judges or on other positions of leadership. oi 14- *^ iand because they spend from their means.} meaning the dowry, 111 *Fath Al-B&ri 7:732*

expenditures and various expenses that Allah ordained in His Book and the Sunnah of His Messenger for men to spend on women. For these reasons it is suitable that he is appointed her maintainer, just as Allah said, *4 lr& 4But men have a degree (of responsibility) over them*}. Qualities of the Righteous Wife Allah said, ^Therefore, the righteous} women, 4l±s} 4are Qanitdt}, obedient to their husbands, as Ibn ‘Abbas and others stated.111 iand guard in the husband's absence} As-Suddi and others said that it

means she protects her honor and her husband's property when he is absent, and Allah's statement, *izvhat* Allah orders them to guard. means, the protected [husband] is the one whom Allah protects.*21 Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah *jg* said, *lil_ tklke-IM lij tLldl* «77ie best woman is she who when you look at her, she pleases you, when you command her she obeys you, and when you are absent, she protects her honor and your property . Then, the Messenger of Allah *jg* recited the Ayah, At-Tabari 8 :294 121 At-Tabari 8 :295

444 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir iMett are the protectors and maintainers of women,} until its end.111 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf said that the Messenger of Allah *jg* said, . L cJif>-j 3 1VU l oju? Ijl IjiSil Irf S4J> Jj a// f/ie woman prayed her five daily prayers, fasted her month, protected her chastity and obeyed her husband, she will be told, 'Enter Paradise from any of its doors you *iyis/ i.'*»*21 Dealing with the Wife's Ill-Conduct Allah said, 4As to those women on whose part you see ill conduct,} meaning, the woman from whom you see ill conduct with her husband, such as when she acts as if she is above her husband, disobeys him, ignores him, dislikes him, and so forth. When these signs appear in a woman, her husband should advise her and remind her of Allah's torment if she disobeys him. Indeed, Allah ordered the wife to obey her husband and prohibited her from disobeying him, because of the enormity of his rights and all that he does for her. The Messenger of Allah *jg* said, *JaP If* u? A>.*-J jl I^T C.'S 'fit aljj'IZ. fii-* •If I were to command anyone to prostrate before anyone, I would have commanded the wife to prostrate before her husband, because of the enormity of his right upon her. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah *j*g* said, *li At-Tabari 8 :295 ^ Ahmad 1 :191 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 4 :323*

*i&'iUi c*ii cjU Kivj ui iii»* «// the man asks his wife to come to his bed and she declines, the angels will keep cursing her until the morning .»,1J Muslim recorded it with the wording, *A ^ l CjL IjJ®* «// the wife goes to sleep while ignoring her husband's bed, the angels will keep cursing her until the morning,^2 This is why Allah said, *Jb}* 4As to those women on whose part you see ill conduct, admonish them (first)}. Allah's statement, *ig&zi* abandon them in their beds,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said "The abandonment refers to not having intercourse with her, to lie on her bed with his back to her."131 Several others said similarly. As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak, 'Ikrimah, and Ibn 'Abbas, in another narration, added, "Not to speak with her or talk to her."*4 l The Sunan and Musnad compilers recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al-Qushayri said, "O Allah's Messenger! What is the right that the wife of one of us has on him?"The Prophet *gf*, said. *I lil iO-Ljt lij Mb* «odi «To feed her when you eat, cloth her when you buy clothes for yourself, refrain from striking her face or cursing her, and to not abandon her, except in the house Allah's statement, 111 Fath Al-Bari9 :205 |2> Muslim 2:1059 At-Jabari 8 :302 141 At-Tabari 8 :302-304 151 Abu Dftwud 2 :606, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 : 375, Ibn Majah 1 :593, Ahmad 5 :3

446 Tafsfr Ibti Kalhir ibeat them} means, if advice and ignoring her in the bed do not produce the desired results, you are allowed to discipline the wife, without severe beating. Muslim recorded that Jabir said that during the Farewell Hajj, the Prophet *sg* said; *^ J 'dlji- <iil * >*. • .<» i > > p , },J » /* "Fear Allah regarding women, for they are your assistants. You have the right on them that they do not allow any person whom you dislike to step on your mat. Hoioever, if they do that, you are allowed to discipline them lightly. They have a right on you that you provide them with their provision and clothes,

in a reasonable manner.»• Ibn ‘Abbas and several others said that the Ayah refers to a beating that is not violent.¹²¹ Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that it means, a beating that is not severe.¹³¹ When the Wife Obeys Her Husband, Means of Annoyance Against Her are Prohibited Allah said, but if they return to obedience, seek not against them means (of annoyance),} meaning, when the wife obeys her husband in all that Allah has allowed, then no means of annoyance from the husband are allowed against his wife. Therefore, in this case, the husband does not have the right to beat her or shun her bed. Allah’s statement, Muslim 8 :886 At-Jabari 8 :314 At-Tabari 8:316

447 Surah 4. An-Nisr (Part-5 i Surely, Allah is Ever Most High, Most Great.> reminds men that if they transgress against their wives without justification, then Allah, the Ever Most High, Most Great, is their Protector, and He will exert revenge on those who transgress against their wives and deal with them unjustly. 435 . If you fear a breach between the two, appoint (two) arbitrators, one from his family and the other from her’s; if they both wish for peace, Allah will cause their reconciliation . Indeed Allah is Ever All-Knower, Well-Acquainted with all things Appointing Two Arbitrators When the Possibility of Estrangement Between Husband and Wife Occurs Allah first mentioned the case of rebellion on the part of the wife. He then mentioned the case of estrangement and alienation between the two spouses. Allah said. a; tSS-j [f, IjLuU CjJl tg ilf you fear a breach between the two, appoint (two) arbitrators, one from his family>. The Fuqaha’ (scholars of Fiqh) say that when estrangement occurs between the husband and wife, the judge refers them to a trusted person who examines their case in order to stop any wrongs committed between them. If the matter continues or worsens, the judge sends a trustworthy person from the woman’s family and a trustworthy person from the man’s family to meet with them and examine their case to determine whether it is best for them to part or to remain together. Allah gives preference to staying together, and this is why Allah said. if they both wish for peace, Allah will cause their reconciliation ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah commands that a righteous man from the husband’s side of the family and the wife’s side of the family are appointed, so

that they find out who among the spouses is in the wrong. If the man is in the wrong, they prevent him from his wife, and he pays some restitution. If the wife is in the wrong, she remains with her husband, and he does not pay any restitution. If the arbitrators decide that the marriage should remain intact or be dissolved, then their decision is upheld. If they decide that the marriage remains intact, but one of the spouses disagrees while the other agrees, and one of them dies, then the one who agreed inherits from the other, while the spouse who did not agree does not inherit from the spouse who agreed.” This was collected by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. Shaykh Abu TJmar bin ‘Abdul-Barr said, “The scholars agree that when the two arbitrators disagree, then the opinion that dissolves the marriage will not be adopted. They also agree that the decision of the arbitrators is binding, even if the two spouses did not appoint them as agents. This is the case if it is decided that they should stay together, but they disagree whether it is binding or not when they decide for separation.” Then he mentioned that the majority holds the view that the decision is still binding, even if they did not appoint them to make any decision. v 4^~^’ •si j’i’j 436. Worship Allah and join none with Him in worship, and do good to parents, kinsfolk, orphans, the poor, the neighbor who is near of kin, the neighbor who is a stranger, the companion by your side, the wayfarer (you meet), and those (slaves) whom your right hands possess. Verily, Allah does not like such as are proud and boastful The Order to Worship Allah Alone and to Be Dutiful to Parents Allah orders that He be worshipped Alone without partners, m At-Tabari 8 :325

because He Alone is the Creator and Sustainer Who sends His favors and bounties on His creation in all situations and instances. Therefore He deserves to be singled out, without associating anything or anyone from His creation with Him in worship. Indeed, the Prophet ﷺ said to Mu'adh, ﷺ U “Do you know what Allah's right on His servants is?” Mu'adh replied, “Allah and His Messenger know better.” He said, “ ﷺ {JjSi% “That they should worship Him and should not worship any others with Him . The Prophet then said, ‘i ji Ijj 4)1 {Jj. U “Do you know what the right of the servants on Allah is if they do this? He should not punish themM 1 ^ Allah then commands the servants to be dutiful to their parents, for Allah made parents the reason for the servants to come to existence, after they did not exist. Allah joins the order to worship Him with being dutiful to parents in many places. For example, He said, iA&j J 4give thanks to Me and to your parents}, and. 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents}. After Allah ordained being dutiful to parents, He ordained kind treatment of relatives, males and females. A Hadith states, J' _ ^ t ^ j, j-SLLJI n.V^iu “Charity given to the poor is Sadaqah, while charity given to m Fath Al-Bari 13 :359

relatives is both Sadaqah and Sildh (keeping the relations).» Allah then said, Orphans}, because they lost their caretakers who would spend on them. So Allah commands that the orphans be treated with kindness and compassion. Allah then said, AAAl-Masakin (the poor)} who have various needs and cannot find what sustains these needs. Therefore, Allah commands they should be helped in acquiring their needs in a sufficient manner that will end their inadequacy. We will further elaborate on the matter of the destitute and the poor in Surah Bara'h (9:60). The Right of the Neighbor Allah said, A the neighbor who is near of kin, the neighbor who is a stranger} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, 44J-->S' <£> jii'j A the neighbor who is near of kin} means, “The neighbor who is also a relative”^{*2} , while, AA\$AX¥ AThe neighbor who is a stranger} means, “Who is not a relative.”^{*31} It was also reported that Tkrimah, Mujahid, Maymun bin Mihran, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Qatadah said similarly.^{*41} Mujahid was also reported to have said that Allah's statement, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 3 :324 * At-Jabari 8 :335 * At-Jabari 8 :338 * At-Tabari 8 :335-336

4^ 4the neighbor who is a stranger> means, “The companion during travel.” 11 There are many Hadiths that command kind treatment to the neighbors, and we will mention some of them here with Allah's help. The First Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Umar said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, ®Ajyy— Aj I “fibril kept reminding of the neighbor's right, until I thought that he was going to give him a share of the inheritance .»² The Two SahOis recorded this HadithP The Second Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, Jrlyf. Jijyr JljUn fibril kept reminding me of the neighbor's right, until I thought he was going to appoint a share of the inheritance for him, i)' Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi recorded this Hadith, which At-Tirmidhi said was “Hasan Gharib through this route.”,s| The Third Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin Al-‘As said that the Prophet ﷺ said, «The best companions according to Allah are those who are the best with their friends, and the best neighbors according to At-Tabari 8:341 121 Ahmad 2 :85 '3| Fath Al-Bari 10:455, Muslim 4:2025 ,4) Ahmad 2:160 Abu Dawud 5:357, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :72-73

“To kill your offspring for fear that he might share your food with you . » I said, Then?’ He said, *J— X>- ob “To commit adultery with your neighbor's wife, d” The Fifth Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that

'A'ishah asked the Messenger of Allah, "I have two neighbors, so whom among them should I give my gift?" He said, "The neighbor whose door is the closest to you.* Al-Bukhari narrated this Hadith ,a| We will elaborate on this subject in the Tafsir of Surah Bard'h, Allah willing and upon Him we depend. Being Kind to Slaves and Servants Allah said, iand those (slaves) whom your right hands possess,} this is an order to be kind to them because they are weak, being held as captives by others. An authentic Hadith records that during the illness that preceded his death, the Messenger of Allah jg continued advising his Ummah oill. Uj s^UJU "(Protect) the prayer, (protect) the prayer, and (those slaves) whom your hands possess.*131 He was repeating it until his tongue was still. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Miqdam bin Ma'dykarib said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said, til] iijJj llj t Hj|Sp »ll] Uj . .••ll. i U Fath Al-Bari 8 :350 , MusUm 1 :90 ^ Ahmad 6:175, Al-Bukhari 6020 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 4 :258

Qiixj? til] jft *>!-->«ul UJ i4*Jlu> till Jj . " * «uf "HTiflf i/om /eed yourself is a Sadaqah (charity) for you, what you feed your children is Sadaqah far you, what you feed your wife is Sadaqah far you and what you feed your servant is Sadaqahfor i/ow.s' 11 An-Nasa'i recorded this Ifadith which has an authentic chain of narration, all the thanks are due to Allah. 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said to a caretaker of his, "Did you give the slaves their food yet?" He said, "No." Ibn 'Amr said, "Go and give it to them, for the Messenger of Allah jS said, i jt t*jl "If is enough sin far someone to prevent whomever he is responsible for from getting their food . Muslim recorded this Hadith . [31 Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet sg said, •j-K u nj juJi^ Jik ij xcys'j ilui Jjiiaj® «77ie slave has the right to have food, clothing and to only be required to perform what he can bear of workj Muslim also recorded this Hadith. Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet jg said, J I — J JLJj ijli l<ulaiaj lj|D J,! iili - jl ll£ uWhett your servant brings meals to one ofyou, if he does not let him sit and share the meal, then he should at least give him a mouthful or two mouthfuls of that meal or a meal or two, for he has prepared if.» |S| This is the wording collected by Al- Bukhari. Allah Does Not Like the Arrogant Allah said, IM Ahmad 4:131 121 An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 5 :376 131 Muslim 2 :692 141 Muslim 3:1284 |S| Fath Al-Bari 5:214, Muslim 3 :1284

ot£==> £ 4^ . Y Saf 6^ i Verily, Allah does not like such as are proud and boastful. meaning, one who is proud and arrogant, insolent and boasts to others. He thinks that he is better than other people, thus thinking high of himself, even though he is insignificant to Allah and hated by people. Mujahid said that Allah's statement, -5 'if lei- iVcrily, Allah does not like such as are proud^ meansarrogant, while, iboastfufy means boasting about what he has, while he does not thank Allah. * This Ayah indicates that such a person boasts with people about the bounty that Allah has given him, but he is actually ungrateful to Allah for this bounty. Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Abdullah bin Waqid Abu Raja' Al- Harawi said, "You will find that those who are mean are also proud and boasting. He then recited, iand those (slaves) whom your right hands possess, J rmm Ae mm Oc 4ijJ ctljoiJ » 5^* LA-r' At-Tabari 8 :350

You will find that he who is undutiful (to parents) is also arrogant, and deprived. He then recited, 1>£ 'fa jfay 4And dutiful to my mother, and made me not arrogant, deprivedty Once a man asked the Prophet, "O Messenger of Allah, advise me.' The Prophet jfe said, *<Livdl >-~>J Y 2tl o'j 4aL»mJI fa jljVj Jllil ijij'ijl Jlli)} did!" "Avoid lengthening the dress (below the ankles), far this practice is from arrogance. Verily, Allah does not like arrogance.s"11 •ii-*** OJ 0>^*SO) . ""j-LUL o Yj o;^' jijtj ClJit tjcf-lj i*-** jl fafr *jl*j rKfaj *—j faj i) ,^3 ii? jSj ijil j-p'jj li* 'jiilfj J «it 437. 77iose who are stingy and

encourage people to be stingy and hide what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounties. And We have prepared for the disbelievers a disgraceful torment 438. And (also) those who spend of their wealth to be seen of men, and believe not in Allah and the Last Day, and whoever takes Shaytan as an intimate; then what a dreadful intimate he is! 439. And what loss have they if they had believed in Allah and in the Last Day, and they spend out of what Allah has given them for sustenance? And Allah is Ever All-Knowing of them. The Censure of Stingy Behavior Allah chastises the stingy behavior of those who refuse to spend their money for what Allah ordered them, such as being kind to parents and compassionate to relatives, orphans, the poor, the relative who is also a neighbor, the companion Ahmad 5 :64

during travel, the needy wayfarer, the slaves and servants. Such people do not give Allah's right from their wealth, and they assist in the spread of stingy behavior. The Messenger of Allah said, 'jy!' *• disease is more serious than being stingy?*11 He also said, «Beware of being stingy, for it destroyed those who were before you, as it encouraged them to cut their relations and they did, and it encouraged them to commit sin and they did.*™ Allah said, Ji •iii ^ Ojr^=*f)} iand hide what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounties,} Therefore, the miser is ungrateful for Allah's favor, for its effect does not appear on him, whether in his food, clothes or what he gives. Similarly, Allah said, M -if k¥ iVerily, man is ungrateful to his Lord. And to that he bears witness.} by his manners and conduct, js£' ^'3^ 4And verily, he is violet in the love of wealth.} Allah said, ui '1*1 Vi hide what Allah has bestowed upon them of His bounties} and this is why He threatened them, Al-Adab Al-Mufrad 83 Abu Dawud 2 : 324

459 Surah 4. An-Nisa' (Part-5) generous.' And it was said..." meaning you acquired your reward in the life, and this is indeed what you sought with your action.111 This is why Allah said, iand believe not in Allah and the Last Day,) meaning, it is Shaytan who lured them to commit this evil action, instead of performing the good deed as it should be performed. Shaytan encouraged, excited and lured them by making the evil appear good, iCJ& i 4And whoever takes Shaytan as an intimate; then what a dreadful intimate he has!) Allah then said, 'y dj jfh i'yfi i&i j* \iZ\$) 4And what loss have they if they had believed in Allah and in the Last Day, and they spend out of what Allah has given them for sustenance?) This Ayah means, what harm would it cause them if they believe in Allah, go on the righteous path, replace showing off with sincerity, have faith in Allah, and await His promise in the Hereafter, for those who do good and spend what He has given them on what He likes and is pleased with. Allah's statement: i\i ^a&) 4And Allah is Ever All-Knowing of them.) means, He has perfect knowledge of their intentions, whether good or evil. Indeed, Allah knows those who deserve success, and He grants them success and guidance, directing them to perform righteous actions that will earn them His pleasure. He also knows those who deserve failure and expulsion from His great mercy, which amounts to utter failure in this life and the Hereafter for them, we seek refuge in Allah from this evil end. (il An-Nasfil 6 :24

The Two Sahih recorded the long Hadith about the intercession that Abu Said Al-Khudri narrated, and in which the Messenger of Allah said, •j&' Is. «Allah then says, "Go back, and take out of the Fire everyone in whose heart you find the weight of a mustard seed of faith" In another narration, Allah says, j* 'yrj>-^ ijUJ ja Sji JliL «i uU u"Whoever had the least, least, least speck of faith, take him out of the

Fire," and they will take out many people .» Abu Said then said, "Read, if you will, if you will, surely! Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust}.*" Will Punishment be Diminished for the Disbelievers? Said bin Jubayr commented about Allah's statement, and if there is any good (done), He doubles it, \$ "As for the disbeliever, his punishment will be lessened for him on the Day of Resurrection, but he will never depart the Fire." He used as evidence the authentic Hadith in which Al-'Abbas said, "O Messenger of Allah! Your uncle Abu Talib used to protect and support you, did you benefit him at all?" The Messenger jgr said, ^jA iljjJl obsj * Cl l ^jA (y jfi. «Yes. He is in a shallow area in Hell-fire, and were it not for me, he would have been in the deepest depths of the Fire. »|21 1,1 Fath Al-Bari 13:413, Muslim 1 : 167 * Al-Bukhari nos . 3883 , 6208 and Muslim no . 209

will tkilif <u l jl» «Allah rewards the good deed with a million deeds.* Abu Hurayrah said, "By Allah! I heard the Messenger of Allah 5g saying, JL tSypl 3)1 jj «Allah rewards the good deed with two million deeds.* He then recited this Ayah, j.K a 4But little is the enjoyment of the life of this world as compared to the Hereafter Our Prophet ^ will be a Witness Against, or For his Ummah on the Day of Resurrection, When the Disbelievers Will Wish for Death Allah said, ^ \$\$« lil 4How (will it be) then, when We bring from each nation a witness and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these people?) Allah describes the horrors, hardships and difficulties of the Day of Resurrection, saying, how would it be on that Day when there will be a witness from every nation, meaning the Prophets, just as Allah said; Q-J 4And the earth will shine with the light of its Lord, and the Book will be placed (open) ; and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward), and, 4And (remember) the Day when We shall raise up from every nation a witness against them from amongst themselves). Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'Ud said, "The I 1 ' Ahmad no. 7932.

464 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Messenger of Allah said to me, 'Recite to me.' I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Should I recite (the Qur'an) to you, while it was revealed to you?' He said, "Yes, for I like to hear it from other people.' I recited Surat An-Nisa' until I reached this Ayah, fin'- ^ (f Cri 'M 4How (will it be) then, when 1Ne bring from each nation a witness and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these people?} He then said, 'Stop now.' I found that his eyes were tearful." ^ Allah's statement, <3li by&, Yj jtjt iSyZ j! iy X^yfr) mu- 40n that day those who disbelieved and disobeyed the Messenger will wish that they were buried in the earth, but they will never be able to hide a single fact from Allah. means, they will wish that the earth would open up and swallow them because of the horror of the gathering place and the disgrace, dishonor and humiliation they will suffer on that Day. This is similar to Allah's statement, X Cwju t, >JY 4The Day when man will see that (the deeds) which his hands have sent forth} Allah then said, 4^& OjSfc\$} ibut they will never be able to hide a single fact from Allah.} indicating that they will admit to everything they did and will not hide any of it. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, "A man came to Ibn 'Abbas and said to him, There are things that confuse me in the Qur'an.' Ibn 'Abbas said, What things do you have doubts about in the Qur'an?' He said, *Not doubts, but rather confusing things.' Ibn 'Abbas said. Tell me what caused you confusion.' He said, 'I hear Allah's statement, m Path Al-Bari 8:712

M 1# i% J3 i ijhere will then be no test for them but to say : "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."4 but He also says, & hf&i 'iff 4but they will never be able to hide a single fact from Allah. They have indeed hid something.' Ibn 'Abbas said, 'As for Allah's

statement, free 4There will then be no test for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."4, vwhen they see that on the Day of Resurrection that Allah does n('it forgive, except for the people of Islam, and that He forgives sins, no matter how big they are, except Shirk, then the Musi r^cs lie. They will say, iffzZ tef U Cp jfj4 4"By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."4, hoping that Allah will forgive them. However, Allah will then seal their mouths > and their hands and feet will disclose what they used to Then, 4@&,,£4 'oJ&% fa dff ') cni' ff4 itthose who disbelieved and disobeyed the Messenger will wish that they weft buried in the earth, but they will never be able to hide a single factfrom Allah.4"ll] iSjf- tsjfd. ffj vpdzf ijJJju v \fp.4 jl jJGJi jt S<A P f j-ju* p o\j \j\ps ^ -St Si ^ & ia| pL rqi' 'Abdur-Razzaq 1

V* os 443 . O you who believe! Do not approach Salah while you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying, nor while Junub (sexually impure), except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body), and if you are ill , or on a journey, or one of you comes from the Gha'it (toilet), or from Lamastum (touching) women, but you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth, rubbing your faces and hands. Truly, Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.4 The Prohibition ofApproaching Prayer When Drunk or Junub Allah forbade His believing servants from praying while drunk, for one does not know the meaning of what he is saying in that state, and He forbade them from attending the Masjids while sexually impure, except when one is just passing through the Masjid from one door to another. This Ayah was revealed before alcohol consumption was completely prohibited, as evident by the Hadxth that we mentioned Surat Al-Baqarah when we explained Allah's statement, 4They ask you about alcoholic drink and gambling In that Hadxth, the Messenger of Allah 4\$, recited this Ayah to TJmar, who said, "O Allah! Explain the ruling aboc^ Khamr (intoxicants) for us in a plain manner." When this Ayah [4:43] was revealed, the Prophet recited it to 'Umar, w^q sti11 said, "O Allah! Explain the ruling about Khamr (intoxicants) for us in a plain manner." After that, they would not drin^K alcohol close to the time of prayer. When Allah's statement, . p2 jLlii £> £ &S vuV£ jhJ'b t££ 40 you who believe! alcoholic drinks, gambling, Al-Ansab, and Al-Azlam [11 are an abomination of Shayatan's handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful. [5:90], until, I1 ' Al-Ansab are stone altars used for the sacrifice of animals to other than Allah . Al-Aztam refers to a type ofarrows used for divination

Surah 4, Att-Nisd' (Part-5 4So, will you not then abstain?) [5:91] was revealed, Umar said, "We abstain, we abstain." In another narration, when the Ayah in Siirat An-Nisa' was revealed, C[&>&&& 2*5 I&5S V 40 you who believe! Do not approach Salah while you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying,} at the time of prayer, the Messenger of Allah jg would have someone proclaim; "Let not any drunk approach the prayer." This is the wording collected by Abu Dawud. [2] Causes of Its Revelation Ibn Abi Hatim has recorded some reports about the incident of its revelation: Sa'd said, "Four Ayat were revealed concerning me. A man from the Ansar once made some food and invited some Muhajirin and Ansar men to it, and we ate and drank until we became intoxicated. We then boasted about our status." Then a man held a camel's bone and injured Sa'd's nose, which was scarred ever since. This occurred before Al-Khamr was prohibited, and Allah later revealed, 4{sj& ijSjju y itiS 40 you who believe! Approach not As-Salat (the prayer) ivhen you are in a drunken state}P' Muslim recorded this HadlthP and the collectors of the Sunan recorded it, with the exception of Ibn Majah.15 m

Ahmad 1 :53 * Abu Dawud 4 :80 * Abu Dawud At-Jayalisi , 28 •4| Muslim 4:1878 * Abu Dawud: 1773, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:466, An-Nasat in Al- Kubra 6 :348

Another Reason Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said, “Abdur- Rahman bin ‘Awf made some food to which he invited us and served some alcohol to drink. When we became intoxicated, and the time for prayer came, they asked someone to lead us in prayer. He recited ‘Say, ‘O disbelievers! I do not worship that which you worship, but we worship that which you worship [refer to the correct wording of the Surah: 109].” Allah then revealed, U csj& ijSjJu y <0 you who believe! Do not approach Salah when you are in a drunken state until you know what you are saying}.”¹¹ This is the narration collected by Ibn Abi Hatim and At- Tirmidhi, who said “Hasan [Gharlb] Sahth.”^[2] Allah’s statement, iuntil you know what you are saying is the best description for when one is intoxicated, that is, when he does not know the meaning of what he is saying. When a person is drunk, he makes obvious mistakes in the recitation and will not be able to be humble during the prayer. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah said, I / X 9 , ^ x | / ^ ^ ^ j ^ y » yx Hfone feels sleepy while he is praying, let him sleep for a while so that he knows the meaning of what he is saying. »^{P1} This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari 141 and An-Nasal 151 In At-Tabari 8 :378 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :380 . What is between the brackets is found in the reference given here. This text is considered authentic, although there are some technical problems with its narration . See the reference noted as well as Al-Mustadrak no. 3199. Ahmad 3:142 [4] Fath Al-Bari 1 :377 |S| An-Nasal 1 :215

some of the narrations of this Hadith, the Messenger jg said, I A J*. « . . .For he might want to ask for forgiveness, but instead curses himself® Allah said, Ate* Sir- inor while Jutiub (sexually impure), except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body),} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement, ji^ ^ Cii }nor while Jutiub (sexually impure), except while passing through, until you bathe (your entire body,} means, “Do not enter the Masjid when you are Junub, unless you are just passing by, in which case, you pass through without sitting down.”² ’ Ibn Abi Hatim said that similar is reported from ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud, Anas, Abu Ubaydah, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Abu Ad-Duha, ‘Ata’, Mujahid, Masruq, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Zayd bin Aslam, Abu Malik, ‘Amr bin Dinar, Al-Hakam bin Utaybah, ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Yahya bin Said Al- Ansari, Ibn Shihab and Qatadah.³ * Ibn Jarir recorded that Yazid bin Abi Habib commented on Allah’s statement, vi cJi -j’j} inor while Junub (sexually impure), except while passing through,} when some men from the Ansar, whose doors literally opened into the Masjid, were sexually impure, and they did not have water, their only way to get water was to pass through the Masjid. So, Allah sent down, 111 FathAl-Bari 1 :375 121 At-Jabari 8 :382 131 At-Tabari 8:381-384

470 Tafsir Ibt Kathir <«or while Juttub (sexually impure), except while passing through,}.” ¹¹ What supports this statement by Yazld bin Abi Habib, may Allah have mercy upon him, is Al-Bukhari’s report in his Sahlh, that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 1Close all the small doors in this Masjid, except that of Abu Bakr. »²> This is what the Prophet jg commanded at the end of his life, knowing that Abu Bakr will be the Khallfah after him, and that he would need to enter the Masjid on numerous occasions to manage the important affairs of the Muslims. Yet, the Messenger of Allah sg commanded that all the small doors that open into the Masjid be closed, except Abu Bakr’s door. Some of the Sunan compilers recorded the Prophet jg saying that only ‘Ali’s door should remain open, but this is an error, what is in

the Sahih is what is correct. In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that 'A'ishah said, "The Messenger of Allah said to me, «Bring me the garment from the Masjid.» I said, 'I am having my period.' He said, "Your period is not in your 'umra." 131 Muslim also collected a similar narration from Abu Hurayrah. 141 This Hadith indicates that the woman is allowed to pass through the Masjid during menses or post-natal bleeding, and Allah knows best. ^ At-Tabari 8 :384. The chain is not authentic. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 :665 t3 * Muslim 1 :245 Muslim 1 :245

471 Surah 4. An-Nisā' (Part-5 Description of Tayammum Allah said, \$ r q * p £ 3 f t i > * - i and if you are ill , or on a journey, or one of you comes from the Gha'it (toilet), or from Ldmastum (touching) women, but you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth, rubbing your face and hands. Truly, Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.} As for the type of illness which would allow Tayammum, it is an illness that one fears would be aggravated by using water, which could be detrimental to a part of the body, or when doing so would prolong an illness. Some scholars said that any type of illness warrants Tayammum, because of the general indications of the Ayah. As for travelling on a journey, it is known, regardless of its length. Allah then said, u pi S3 ft} ior comes from the Gha'it}. The Gha'it is, literally, the flat land ,1 and this part of the Ayah refers to the minor impurity. Allah then said, £3 ft} ior you Ldmastum women}, which was recited Lamastum and Ldmastum, referring to sexual intercourse. For instance, Allah said in another Ayah, 4,'fSj u Jq* 1 b> eft ft 45 oj j£} 4 And if you divorce them before you have touched them, and you have appointed unto them the dowry, then pay half of that} [2:237], and. p a ftp* 'ft iSi XftX ft\£} 40 you who believe! When you marry believing women, and m That is , where one goes to relieve oneself.

then divorce them before you have touched them, no 'iddah (period of waiting) have you to count in respect of than^ [33 :49]. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that Allah's statement, }or Lamastum women^ refers to sexual intercourse. It was reported that 'Ali, Ubayy bin Kala, Mujahid, Tawus, Al-Hasan, Tjbayd bin Umayr, Said bin Jubayr, Ash-Shalii, Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said similarly. Allah said, X Vj4 i but you do not find water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth,} In the Two Sahih, it is recorded that Imran bin Husayn said, vUu U j*Ai Ij* : Jlii ^ (** Jig <3)1 J_ ^j jj j b *,_jb 1S J>-y! c-Ui 3' j , * 0 «Allah's Messenger saw a person sitting away from the people and not praying with them. He asked him, 'O so-and-so! What prevented you from offering the prayer with the people, are not you Muslim?' He replied, 'Yes, O Allah's Messenger! I am Junub and there is no water.' The Prophet jg said, 'Perform Tayammum with clean earth and that will be sufficient for you.'*3 The linguistic meaning of Tayammum is to intend, as Arabs say, "May Allah Tayammamaka (direct at you) His care." 'Clean earth' means dust. In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said. 111 ciyr-j wijj i nS lii c..!..>- (1 * At-Tabari 8 :392 At-Tabari 8 : 392-393 > Fath Al-Bari 1 :545, Muslim 1 :474

oiUJl JU lil J <We were given preference over people in three things. Our lines (in prayer) were arranged in rows to resemble the rows of the angels, all of the earth was made a Masjid for us, and its dust was made clean for us when there is no water. »(1 ' The Messenger sg mentioned the favor of making dust a purifier for us, and if there were any other substance to replace it for Tayammum, he would have mentioned it. Imam Ahmad and the collectors of Sunan, with the exception of Ibn Majah, recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, OJj jj ,iall JiJj jU fc U oJL>-J t

«Clean earth is pure for the Muslim, even if he does not find water for ten years . When he finds water, let him use it for his skin, for this is better. 121 At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahth”. Allah’s statement, rubbing your faces and hands (Tayammum)} indicates that Tayammum is a substitute for normal ablution, not that it involves cleaning the parts that normal ablution does. Therefore, it is sufficient in Tayammum to just wipe the face and hands, as the consensus concurs. The face and hands are wiped with one strike on the sand in this case, as Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Abza said that a man came to Tjmar and asked him, “I am Junub, but there is no water.” ‘Umar said, “Then, do not pray.” ‘Ammar said, “Do you not remember, O Leader of the Faithful! You and I were on a military expedition when we became Junub and did not find water. You did not pray, but I rolled myself in the sand and then prayed. When we went back to the Prophet, we mentioned to him what had happened. He said to me, ^ Muslim 1 : 371 ,2) Ahmad 5:180, Abu Dawud 1:235, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:388, An- Nasal 1:171

475 Surah 4. An-Nisa' (Part-5) AT mm '*lud6 ' >"* I >t' ' .1f"- Oj!jiiJ'2^a*3»1 o^f*^ '0.}?>*; 1) oj Allah said in this Ayah, k jfetc&& rubbing your faces and hands. Truly , Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning Oft-Forgiving .)> meaning, a part of His pardoning and forgiving is that He allows you to use Tayammum and to pray after using it when there is no water, to make things easy for you. This Ayah sanctifies the position of the prayer, it being too sacred than to be performed in a defecient manner, like in a state of drunkenness, until one becomes aware of what he is saying, or sexually impure, until he bathes (GhusQ, or after answering the call of nature, until he performs ablution. There are exceptions when one is ill or when there is no water. In this case, Allah allows us to use Tayammum, out of His mercy and kindness for His servants, and to facilitate them, all praise is due to Allah. laj 1-)\J-5{j* 1*1^ jA ill) jIUjCjl OJjb Ju jVylJo jl * \ Kf' -J *- V/ # 0yytojOjaIla) Ca ~— \$•SL^i lyLC- Jilil? iil

The Reason behind allowing Tayammum

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1171–1173]

Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “We set out with Allah’s Messenger sg on one of his journeys until we reached Al-Bayda’ or Dhat-ul-Jaysh, where a necklace of mine was broken (and lost). Allah’s Messenger jg stayed there to search for it, and so did the people along with him. There was no water source or any water with them at that place, so the people went to Abu Bakr As-Siddlq and said, ‘Don’t you see

what ‘A’ishah has done! She has made Allah’s Messenger and the people stay where there is no source of water and they have no water with them.’ Abu Bakr came while Allah’s Messenger jg was sleeping with his head on my thigh. He said to me, "You have detained Allah’s Messenger and the people where there is no source of water and they have no water with them.’ So he admonished me and said what Allah wished him to say and hit me on my flank with his hand. Nothing prevented me from moving (because of pain) but the position of Allah’s Messenger on my thigh. Allah’s Messenger jg got up when dawn broke and there was no water. So Allah revealed the verses of Tayammum, and they all performed Tayammum. Usayd bin Hudayr said, ‘O the family of Abu Bakr! This is not the first blessing of yours.’ Then the camel on which 1 was riding was moved from its place and the necklace was found beneath it.” ’ Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this Hadith.’2| J s* 'jpJ sj' Ji j jyfy cA ji&i' oySi Si \$3 ii'j (*^ 'j£-

o& '£&*} C&t) IjSli 444. Hae you not seen those (the Jews) who were given a portion of the Book, purchasing the wrong path, and wishing that you should go astray from the right path.} 445. Allah has full knowledge of your enemies, and Allah is sufficient as a Wali (Protector), and Allah is sufficient as a Helper.} 446. Among those who are Jews, there are some who displace words from (their) right places and say: "We hear your word and disobey," and "Hear and let you hear nothing." And Rd'ina with a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion . And if only they had said "We hear and obey", and "Do make us understand," it would have been better for them, 111 Fath Al-B&ri 1 :514 '2) Fath Al-B&ri 7 :24, 12 :180 and Muslim 1 :279

and more proper ; but Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so they believe not except a feiv.\$ Chastising the Jews for Choosing Misguidance, Altering Allah's Words, and Mocking Islam Allah states that the Jews, may Allah's continued curse fall on them until the Day of Resurrection, have purchased the wrong path instead of guidance, and ignored what Allah sent down to His Messenger Muhammad g£. They also ignored the knowledge that they inherited from previous Prophets, about

the description of Muhammad 5S5 , so that they may have a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1173–1183]

small amount of the delights of this life. iand wishing that you should go astray from the right path> for they would like that you disbelieve in what was sent down to you, O believers, and that you abandon the guidance and beneficial knowledge that you have. \$Allah has full knowledge of your enemies> meaning, Allah has better knowledge of your enemies, and He warns you against them. iand Allah is sufficient as a Wali (Protector), and Allah is Sufficient as a Helper He is a Sufficient Protector for those who seek refuge with Him and a Sufficient Supporter for those who seek His help. Allah then said, 4 u i there are some who displace words from (their) right places } meaning, they intentionally and falsely alter the meanings of the Words of Allah and explain them in a different manner than what Allah meant, 4And say 'We hear your word and disobey'^ saying, "We hear what you say, O Muhammad, but we do not

obey you in it," as Mujahid and Ibn Zayd explained. 111 This is the implied meaning of the Ayah, and it demonstrates the Jews' disbelief, stubbornness and disregard for Allah's Book after they understood it, all the while aware of the sin and punishment that this behavior will earn for them. Allah's statement, 4And "Hear and let you hear nothing. means, hear our words, may you never hear anything, as Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas. 121 This is the Jews' way of mocking and jesting, may Allah's curse descend on them. 4And Ra'ina, zoith a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion meaning, they pretend to say, 'Hear us,' when they say, Ra'ina (an insult in Hebrew, but in Arabic it means 'Listen to us.).' Yet, their true aim is to curse the Prophet jg. We mentioned this subject when we explained Allah's statement, i&A ijSJj y \p\ : 40 you who believe! Say not Ra'ina but say Utizurnd (make us understand)>. Therefore, Allah said about them, while they pretend to say other than what they truly mean, 4l«J' 4 ^ iWith a twist of their tongues and as a mockery of the religion> because of their cursing the Prophet afe. Allah then said, * a m gs as; y 4And if only they had said : "We hear and obey", and "Do make us understand," it zvould have been better for them, and more proper; but Allah has cursed them for their disbelief, so At-Tabari 8 :433 At-Tabari 8 :434

they believe not except a feiv .> meaning, their hearts are cast away from the path of righteousness and therefore, no beneficial part of faith enters it. Earlier, when we explained, 4y£& £ tfjS 4so little is that which they believe which means they do not have beneficial faith. 'J ^ j:t sig ^ CT^ i ui»,, yj' joii j jj u **i As~i & yyy 447. O you who have been given the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed confirming what is ivith you, before We efface faces and turn them backwards or curse them as We cursed the people of the Sabbath. And the commandment ofAllah is always executed 448. Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but Heforgives except that to whom He wills; and whoever sets up partners with Allah in worship, he has indeed invented a tremendous sin. Calling the People of the Book to Embrace the Faith, Warningthem Against Doing Otherwise Allah commands the People of the Scriptures to believe in what He has sent down to His servant and Messenger, Muhammad jg, the Glorious Book that conforms to the good news that they already have about Muhammad He also warns them, 4before We efface faces and turn them backwards> Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that ‘effacing’ here refers to blindness, 4and turn them backioards£ meaning. We put their faces on

their backs, and make them walk backwards, since their eyes will be in their backs. 111 Similar was said by Qatadah and ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi. 121 This makes the punishment even more severe, and it is a parable that Allah set for ignoring the truth, preferring the wrong way and turning away from the plain path for the paths of misguidance. Therefore, such people walk backwards. Similarly, some said that Allah’s statement, (*-f> iuil pf&d 3 Lu>- 4 Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up. And We have put a barrier before them that is a parable that Allah gave for their deviation and hindrance from guidance. Ka*b Al-Ahbar Embraces Islam Upon Hearing thisAyah [4:47] It was reported that Kab Al-Ahbar became Muslim when he heard this Ayah [4:47]. Ibn Jarir recorded that Isa bin Al- Mughlrah said: We were with Ibrahim when we talked about the time when Kab became Muslim. He said, ‘Kab became Muslim during the reign of ‘Umar, for he passed by Al- Madlnah intending to visit Jerusalem, and “Umar said to him, "Embrace Islam, O Kab.’ Kab said, ‘Do you not read in vour Book, AThe likeness of those who were entrusted with the Tawrah [62:5] until, iBooks I am among those who were entrusted with the Tawrah.’ “Umar left him alone and Kab went on to Hims (in Syria) and heard one of its inhabitants recite this Ayah while m At-Tabari 8:440 At-Tabari 8:441

481Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) feeling sad, Ujij 0--.W> J Jj U lix^i Gy G ijl*. 'A>^ 40 yo» who have been given the Scripture (Jews and Christians)! Believe in what We have revealed confirming what is with you, before We effacefaces and turn them backwards}. Ka*b said, *1 believe, O Lord! I embraced Islam, O Lord!’ for He feared that this might be struck by this threat. He then went back to his family in Yemen and returned with them all as Muslims.”111 Allah’s statement, & TS3 CT #SB }X 4or curse them as We cursed the people of the Sabbath.} refers to those who breached the sanctity of the Sabbath, using deceit, for the purpose of doing more work. Allah changed these people into apes and swine, as we will come to know in the explanation of Surat Al-A‘raf (7). Allah’s statement, 4And the commandment ofAllah is ahvays executed.} means, when He commands something, then no one can dispute or resist His command. Allah Does not Forgive Shirk, Except After Repenting From it Allah said that He, iforgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship),} meaning, He does not

forgive a servant if he meets Him while he is associating partners with Him, 6ji C fuij} m At-Tabari 8 : 446

Two Sahihs recorded this Hadth^ Al-Bazzar recorded that Ibn 'Umar said, "We used to refrain from begging (Allah) for forgiveness for those who commit major sins until we heard our Prophet \$g reciting, J v it ift iai d JkLy 4 Verify, A//a/i forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but He for- gives except that (any- thing else) to whom He wills ft, and his jg saying, jJC&I JaS/ in \y. J "7 have reserved my intercession on the Day of Resurrection for those among my Ummah who commit major sins. Allah's statement, Oii *it> iand whoever sets up partners with Allah in worship, he has indeed invented a tremendous sin ft is similar to His statement, i^ Fath Al-Bari 10 :294 and Muslim 1 :95 ' KashfAl-Astar 4 :84 ^ asstii> av asm U * < i> > y<\jt* <" " l'h^ i« / ^ '-I-- r oy- j >- ^61^ jl |>ji2uS("j\yJ > A>* * < / - •< 1 At* . * > »/ .>

Tafsir Ibti Kathir iVerihj, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed. } In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Which is the greatest sin?' He said. "To make a rival with Allah, while He Alone created t/ow . » " * 1 '-S jl" y* ^S jl j Iri J\ A 3 ; j* ffT) «il JJjS' ui y' 4*jt£«« ,4 «** «il> jtpj (Ililjl "a'.jLjl 449. Have you not seen those who claim sanctity for themselves? Nay, but Allah sanctifies whom He wills, and they ivill not be dealt with injustice even equal to the extent of a Fatil.} 450. Look, how they invent a lie against Allah, and enough is that as a manifest sin.} 451 . Have you not seen those who were given a portion of the Scripture? They believe in Jibt and Tdghut and say to those who disbelieve, "These people are better guided on the way," than the believers.} 452. They are those whom Allah has cursed, and he whom Allah curses, you will not find for him (any) helper.} Chastising and Cursing the Jews for Claiming Purity for Themselves and Believing in Jibt and Tdghut Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, "This Ayah, <r&& >& IS Ji j 4Have you not seen those who claim sanctity for themselves?} . was revealed about the Jews and Christians when they said, *We are Allah's children and His loved ones." *21 Ibn Zayd also Path Al-Bari 8 :350 and Muslim 1 :90 At-Tabari 8 :452

said, "This Ayah was revealed concerning their statement, iWe are the children of Allah and His loved ones} and their statement, ofA S\ Sitf£% J} iNone shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jew or a Christian}.'*" This is why Allah said, 4'<&. J* -it 4Nay, but Allah sanctifies whom He wills,} meaning, the decision in this matter is with Allah Alone, because He has perfect knowledge of the true reality and secrets of all things. Allah then said, 4U oA& \$And they will not be dealt with injustice even equal to the extent of a Fatil,} meaning, He does no injustice with anyone's compensation in any part of his reward, even if it was the weight of a FatiL Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata', Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others among the Salaf said that FatU means, "The scaly thread in the long slit of the date-stone."12* Allah said, 4'rffR ^Jif jc OJLMJ J3T \$a\} iLook, how they invent a lie against Allah,} claiming purity for themselves, their claim that they are Allah's children and His loved ones, their statement; 4%jZ ji ISA ofA S[ssyf j} iNone shall enter Paradise unless he be a Jew or a Christian} their statement; ip&S <4% Jdlf i££j j} 111 At-Tabari 8 :453 ,2* At-Tabari 8 :458,459

486 Tafsir Ibti Kathir iThe Fire shall not touch us but for a number of days} and their reliance on the righteous deeds of their forefathers. Allah has decreed that the good actions of the fathers do not help the children, when He said, U cjff U LfJ oii- iil \$f} iTfjat was a nation who has passed away. They shall

receive the reward of what they earned and you of what you earn}. Allah then said, and enough is that as a manifest sin.} meaning, these lies and fabrications of theirs are sufficient. Allah's statement, Si lib' ditM jl ffi} iHave you not seen those who were given a portion of the Scripture? They believe in Jibt and Tdghiit}. Muhammad bin Ishaq said from Hassan bin Fa'id that 'Umar bin Al-Khat{ab said, "Jibt is sorcery and Tdghiit is the Shaytan."1 11 Abu Nasr Ismail bin Hammad Al-Jawhari, the renowned scholar, said in his book As-Sihah, aAl-Jibt means idol, soothsayer and sorcerer." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah was asked about Taghut, and he said, "They are soothsayers upon whom the devils descend."121 Mujahid said "Tdghiit is a devil in the shape of man, and they refer to him for judgment."131 Imam Malik said, "Taghut is every object that is worshipped instead of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored." Disbelievers Are not Better Guided Than Believers Allah said, 4%^ i\$ Si Sfr\& uii iand say to those who disbelieve, "These people are better guided on the way," than the believers.} At-Jabari 8 :462 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :994 •3| At-Tabari 8 :462

487 Surah 4. An-Nisid' (Part-5) preferring the disbelievers over Muslims, because of their ignorance, un-religious nature and disbelief in Allah's Book which is before them. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Ikrimah said, "Huyay bin Akhtab and Ka'b bin Al-Ashraf (two Jewish leaders) came to the people of Makkah, who said to them, 'You (Jews) are people of the Book and knowledge, so judge us and Muhammad.' They said, 'Describe yourselves and describe Muhammad.' They said, "We keep relation with kith and kin, slaughter camels (for the poor), release the indebted and provide water for the pilgrims. As for Muhammad he is without male children, he severed our relations, and the thieves who rob pilgrims (the tribe of) Ghifar follow him. So who is better, we or him?' They said, "You are more righteous and better guided.' Thereafter, Allah sent down, iCJ. liji ji j jty 4Have you not seen those who were given a portion}." 1^ This story was also reported from Ibn 'Abbas and several others among the Salaf. Allah's Curse on the Jews This Ayah [4:52] contains a curse for the Jews and informs them that they have no supporter in this life or the Hereafter, because they sought the help of the idolators. They uttered this statement [in Ayah 4:51] to lure the disbelievers into supporting them, and they ultimately gathered their forces for

the battle of Al-Ahzab,121 forcing the Prophet jfe and his

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Companions to dig a defensive tunnel around Al-Madlnah. But, Allah saved the Muslims from their evil, 4And Allah drove back those who disbelieved in their rage, they gained no advantage (booty). Allah sufficed for the believers in the fighting. And Allah is Ever All-Strong, All-Mighhfi. t 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim 3 :994, and At-Tabari 5 :133 121 See SuratAl-Ahzab (33)

t* J* Cyilj£ .»! js ,44 « •4Ch_> (cKift ^* -ii* ji <i' 4 4. .L» ,ji i^uj .j, J^\\, 453 . Or have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir.} 454. Or do they envy men for what Allah has given them of His bounty? Then, We have already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and Al-Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom. Of them were (some) who believed in it, and of them were (some) who rejected it; and enough is Hell for burning (them). The Envy and Miserly Conduct of the Jews Allah asked the Jews if they have a share in the dominion. That is merely a statement of rebuke, since they do not have any share in the dominion. Allah then described them as

misers, 4'P? tPlilf 5yjj V \>fo 4Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir.} Meaning, if they had a share in the sovereignty and dominion, they would not give anyone anything, especially Muhammad jfc, even if it was the speck on the back of a date- stone, which is the meaning of Naqir according to Ibn 'Abbas and the majority of the scholars. This Ayah is similar to another of Allah's statements, 4Say : ",Ifyou possessed the treasure of the mercy ofmy Lord, then you would surely withhold it out offear ofspending it.} meaning, for fear that what you have might end, although there is no such possibility here. This only demonstrates their greedy and stingy nature. This is why Allah said, hpPym 4And man is ever Qatiir\$ meaning Bakhil (stingy). Allah then said,

489Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) 40r do they envy menfor what Allah has given them ofHis Bounty?} referring to their envy of the Prophet for the great prophethood that Allah entrusted him with. Their envy made them reject him, because he was an Arab and not from the Children of Israel. At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 40r do they envy men^ means, "We are the worthy people, rather than the rest ofthe people. |11 Allah said, 4Jhen, We have already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and Al-Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom .} meaning, We gave the prophethood to the tribes of the Children of Israel, who are among the offspring of Ibrahim and sent down the Books to them. These Prophets ruled the Jews with the prophetic tradition, and We made kings among them. Yet, 4-* Ir (>r^ iOf them were (some) who believed in it;} referring to Allah's favor and bounty (Prophets, Books, kingship). . • >T iand ofthem were (some) who rejected it} by disbelieving in it, ignoring it, and hindering the people from its path, although this bounty was from and for them, the Children of Israel. They disputed with their own Prophets; so what about you, O Muhammad s&, especially since you are not from the Children of Israel? Mujahid said, 40fthem were (some) who believed in [him],} "Muhammad jg, Ay i a- [1 * At-Tabarani 1 1 :146

iand ofthem were (some) who rejected [him].)^ Therefore, O Muhammad, the rejection of you because of their disbelief is even more severe and they are even further from the truth that you brought them. This is why Allah threatened them, iand enough is Hell for bunting (them).), meaning, the Fire is a just punishment for them because of their disbelief, rebellion and defiance ofAllah's Books and Messengers. lA be* (**»jS*- Os' ijii ppUai jfit VI? tjj 6,1 Ijj Qje j; J/? 456. Surely, those who disbelieved in Our Ayat, We shall bum them in Fire. As often as their skins are roasted through, We shall change them for other skins that they may taste the punishment. Truly, Allah is Ever Most Powerful, All-Wise.) 457. But those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which riversflow (Paradise), abiding therein forever. Therein they shall have Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates), and We shall admit them to shades, wide and ever deepening.) The Punishment of Those Who Disbelieve in Allah's Books and Messengers Allah describes the torment in the Fire of Jahannam for those who disbelieve in His Ayat and hinder from the path of His Messengers. Allah said, iSurely, those who disbelieved in Our Ayat ,) meaning, We will place them in the Fire which will encompass every part of their bodies. Allah then states that their punishment and torment are everlasting, ^ At-Tabari 8:482, meaning the personal pronoun Ha was understood by "him" to be "him" rather than "it".

il&\ iy/xi££ «s£ ^Si; pisjt^ 4We s/ia/Z bum them in Fire. As often as their skins are roasted through, We shall change them for other skins that they may taste the punishment}. Al-A'mash said that Ibn 'Umar said, "When their skin are burned, they will be given another skin in replacement, and this skin will be

as white as paper.” 1 11 This was collected by Ibn Abi Hatim, who also recorded that Al-Hasan said, 4A\$ often as their skins are roasted through,} “Their skin will be roasted through, seventy thousand times every day.” Husayn said; Fudayl added that Hisham said that Al-Hasan also said that, 4As often as their skins are roasted through, means, “Whenever the Fire has roasted them through and consumed their flesh, they will be told, ‘Go back as you were before,’ and they will.”¹² The Wealth of the Righteous; Paradise and its Joy Allah said, 4Q it#. y*T\ \pabM iBut those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), abiding therein forever.} describing the destination of the happy ones in the gardens of Eden, beneath which rivers flow in all of its areas, spaces and comers, wherever they desire and wish. They will reside in it for eternity, and they will not be transferred or removed from it, nor would they want to move from it. Allah said, i*Z At-Tabari 8 :484 121 Al-Tabari 8 :485

iTherein they shall have Azwajun Mutahharatun (purified mates), free of menstruation, postnatal bleeding, filth, bad manners and shortcbmings. Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah means, “They are purified of filth and foul things.”¹¹ Similar was said by ‘Ata’, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, An-Nakhal, Abu Salih, ‘Atiyah, and As-Suddi.² Mujahid said that they are, free of urine, menstruation, spit, mucous and pregnancies.” Allah’s statement, &>QZj} AAnd We shall admit them to shades, wide and ever deepening (Paradise).} means, wide, extensive, pure and elegant shade. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, <uUdi i’fiJ : giki; v au 4kj 444)1 Vjklj &jij jj. “There is a tree in Paradise, that if a rider travels under its shade for a hundred years, he loill not cross it. It is the Tree of Everlasting Life. n' ^ - r ^ -v / M<>; ol ol 458. Verily, Allah commands that you should render back the trusts to those, to whom they are due; and that when you judge between men, you judge with justice. Verily, how excellent is the teaching which He (Allah) gives you! Truly, Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Command to Return the Trusts to Whomever They Are Due Allah commands that the trusts be returned to their rightful At-Tabari 1 :395 Ibn Abi Hatim 1 :92 At-Tabari 8 :489 It is also recorded by Ahmad and At-Tayalisi. This version, with the words, ‘The Tree of Everlasting Life.’ Is not authentic. The remainder of the Hadlth, which is authentic, was recorded by Al-Bukhari and others.

owners. Al-Hasan narrated that Samurah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, NJ l JI iUSll il 11 oReturn the trust to those who entrusted you, and do not betray those who betrayed you . » Imam Ahmad and the collectors of Sunan recorded this Hadith . [1] This command refers to all things that one is expected to look after, such as Allah’s rights on His servants: praying, Zakah, fasting, penalties for sins, vows and so forth. The command also includes the rights of the servants on each other, such as what they entrust each other with, including the cases that are not recorded or documented. Allah commands that all types of trusts be fulfilled. Those who do not implement this command in this life, it will be extracted from them on the Day of Resurrection. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jg said, cLLu jpdjSj iil>i i «77ie rights will be rendered back to those to whom they are due, and even the sheep that does not have horns will take revenge front the homed sheep »¹² Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Jurayj said about this Ayah, “It was revealed concerning TJthman bin Talhah from whom the Messenger of Allah jg took the key of the Ka*bah and entered it on the Day of the victory of Makkah. When the Prophet jg went out, he was reciting this Ayah, 'j3 i) py\ & i Verily, Allah commands that you should render back the trusts to those, to whom they are due}. He then called TJthman and gave the key back to him.” Ibn Jarir also narrated that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, “When the Messenger

of Allah >g went out of the Ka*bah, he was reciting this Ayah, > & 'f'yk l)^ Ahmad 3 :414 , Abu Dawud 3 :805 and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :479 121 Muslim 4:1097

iVerily, Allah commands that you should render back the trusts to those, to whom they are due}. May I sacrifice my father and mother for him, I never heard him recite this Ayah before that." ' It is popular that this is

the reason behind revealing the Ayah (4:58). Yet, the application of the Ayah is general, and this is why Ibn 'Abbas and Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah said, "This Ayah is for the righteous and wicked," meaning it is a command that encompasses everyone. The Order to Be Just Allah said, iand that when you judge between men, you judge with justice.} commanding justice when judging between people. Muhammad bin Ka'b, Zayd bin Aslam and Shahr bin Hawshab said; "This Ayah was revealed about those in authority",121 meaning those who judge between people. A Hadith states, j! 2>i iSSj ju- ty u £ at !>)» 11Allah is with the judge as long as he does not commit injustice, for when he does, Allah will make him reliant on himself.*13 ' A statement goes, "One day of justice equals forty years of worship."141 Allah said, 44 ^3 li} iVerily, haw excellent is the teaching which He (Allah) gives you!} At-Tabari 8:492, as well as others. The narrations, about the revelation of the Ayah, and the statement of "Umar, may Allah be pleased with him , are not authentic . There is , however a narration supporting the remainder of the information with Al-Bukhari, no. At-Tabari 8 :490 Ibn Majah 2 :775 ^ Al-Kanz 6:12

meaning, His commands to return the trusts to their owners, to judge between people with justice, and all of His complete, perfect and great commandments and laws. Allah's statement, 4&# L? gf at iTruly, Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} means, He hears your statements and knows your actions. JI i#& app 4% A !£& * ltd Sit <#£} 4f?t%\z %& jJSi jt 4 &.% \$ 459. O you who believe! Obey Allah and obey the Messenger, and those ofyou who are in authority. Ifyou differ in anything among yourselves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger, if you believe in Allah and in the Last Day. That is better and more suitableforfinal determination.} The Necessity of Obeying the Rulers in Obedience to Allah Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, 4%4 fit\$ & \$£> 40bey Allah and obey the Messenger, and those ofyou who are in authority.} "Was revealed about 'Abdullah bin Hudhafah bin Qays bin 'Adi, who the Messenger of Allah sent on a military expedition." ' This statement was collected by the Group, with the exception of Ibn Majah'2 ' At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan, Gharib". Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Ali said, "The Messenger of Allah sent a troop under the command of a man from Al- Ansar. When they left, he became angry with them for some reason and said to them, 'Has not the Messenger of Allah sg commanded you to obey me?' They said, 'Yes.' He said, 'Collect some wood,' and then he started a fire with the wood, saying, 1 command you to enter the fire.' The people almost entered the fire, but a young man among them said, "You only ran away 111 FathAl-Bari 8:101 [2' Muslim 3:1465, Abu Dawud 3:92, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:364 and An-Nasal 7:154

from the Fire to Allah's Messenger. Therefore, do not rush until you go back to Allah's Messenger, and if he commands you to enter it, then enter it.' When they went back to Allah's Messenger jg, they told him what had happened, and the Messenger jg said, «Hfld you entered it, you would never have departed from it. Obedience is only in righteousness, n"11 This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahths. Abu Dawud recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, i y>jj U ufj

LJ-\ ll_j pL.ll I .^Jl ^LUI» Vj 4_,rT» ...I 'The Muslim is required to hear and obey in that which he likes and dislikes, unless he was commanded to sin. When he is commanded with sin, then there is no hearing or obeying. » This Hadith is recorded in the Two SahihsP TJbadah bin As-Samit said, “We gave our pledge to Allah’s Messenger to hear and obey (our leaders), while active and otherwise, in times of ease and times of difficulty, even if we were deprived of our due shares, and to not dispute this matter (leadership) with its rightful people. The Prophet jg said, 4)1 {j* *J pSi^ ‘ \s jt Vlt “Except when you wihess clear Kufr about which you have clear proof from Allah . This Hadith is recorded in the Two SahihsP Another Hadith narrated by Anas states that the Messenger of Allah jg said, (j{£ p£lle-~J»\ jjJ t I yJ»ij IlyiLUU “Hear and obey (your leaders), even if an Ethiopian slave whose head is like a raisin, is made your chiefJ 111 Ahmad 1 :82 Fath Al-Bari 7 :655 , Muslim 3 :1469 Abd Dawud : 2626, Bukhari : 7144 and Muslim : 1839 Path Al-Bari 13 :204 , Muslim 3 :470

Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith} Umm Al-Husayn said that she heard the Messenger of Allah jg giving a speech during the Farewell Hajj, in which he said; ijijl . illSL JLc 3 «Et>en i/a s/«z;e was appointed over you, and he rules you with Allah's Book, then listen to him and obey him. Muslim recorded this HadithJ2 In another narration with Muslim, the Prophet jg said, •UjJl \L^J- Ul*» Even if an Ethiopian slave, whose nose was mutilated... » In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sfe said, -li* {y>j lil jui JJ>J i<ill Eli>1 jli ja U^ ir** ‘a*j ^Whoever obeys me, obeys Allah, and whoever disobeys me, disobeys Allah. Whoever obeys my commander, obeys me, and whoever disobeys my commander, disobeys me. s'31 This is why Allah said, 4& 40bey Allah}, adhere to His Book, iand obey the Messenger}, adhere to his Sunnah, 4And those ofyou who are in authority in the obedience to Allah which they command you, not what constitutes disobedience of Allah, for there is no obedience to anyone in disobedience to Allah, as we mentioned in the authentic Hadith, m Fath Al-Bari 13:130 121 Muslim :1838 * Fath Al-Bari 13:119 and Muslim 3 :1466

498 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir j UiLji u!i» «Obedience is only in righteousness .»[li The Necessity of Referring to the Qur’an and Sunnah for Judgment Allah said, Ji w? a i(And) if you differ in anything amongst your- selves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger}. Mujahid and several others among the Salaf said that the Ayah means, “(Refer) to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger.”*21 This is a command from Allah that whatever areas the people dispute about, whether major or minor areas of the religion, they are required to refer to the Qur’an and Sunnah for judgment concerning these disputes. In another Ayah, Allah said, J amm AA OyOliM dills 'j»Jjiltj ^to \$6,Si ijil—ls ^J 4\$ ib^3a3 jj -piU. 4-And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah}. Therefore, whatever the Book and Sunnah decide and testify to the truth of, then it, is the plain truth. What is beyond truth, save falsehood? This is why Allah said, 111 FathAi-Bdri 13:130 At-Jabari 8:504

<*9 iifyou believe in Allah and in the Last Day.} meaning, refer the disputes and conflicts that arise between you to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger for judgment. Allah’s statement, p o> iifyou believe in Allah and in the Last Day.} indicates that those who do not refer to the Book and Sunnah for judgment in their disputes, are not believers in Allah or the Last Day. Allah said, iThat is better} meaning, referring to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger for judgment in various disputes is better, iand more suitable for final determination.} meaning, “Has a better end and destination,” as As-Suddi and several others have stated * while Mujahid said, “Carries a better

reward.”*21 ot Ouli jjll Lj «iU[tL *>-•» ji+it olrjll' p} ol 4 L0S3 cJ VJ ^ Sjli. ^ jis^^ p te f^ P Hi** ^2 tL* f.rSjii^ 4 ii £f j^5 ^5}1 jJcUS il^i tSX,1 oi A^ i60. Have you not seen those (hypocrites) who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you, and they wish to go for judgment (in their disputes) to the Taghut while they have been 111 At-Tabari 8 :506 *21 At-Tabari 8 :506

ordered to reject them. But Shaytan wishes to lead them far astray 461 . And when it is said to them : "Come to what Allah has sent down and to the Messenger," you see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion. 462. How then, when a catastrophe befalls them because of what their hands have sent forth, they come to you swearing by Allah, 'We meant no more than goodwill and conciliation!'" 463. They (hypocrites) are those of whom Allah knows what is in their hearts; so turn aside from them (do not punish them) but admonish them, and speak to them an effective word to reach their inner selves.} Referring to Other than the Qur'an and Sunnah for Judgment is Characteristic of Non-Muslims Allah chastises those who claim to believe in what Allah has sent down to His Messenger jg and to the earlier Prophets, yet they refer to other than the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger jg for judgment in various disputes. It was reported that the reason behind revealing this Ayah was that a man from the Ansar and a Jew had a dispute, and the Jew said, "Let us refer to Muhammad to judge between us." However, the Muslim man said, "Let us refer to Kah bin Al- Ashraf (a Jew) to judge between us." It was also reported that the Ayah was revealed about some hypocrites who pretended to be Muslims, yet they sought to refer to the judgment of Jahiliyyah. Other reasons were also reported behind the revelation of the Ayah. However, the Ayah has a general meaning, as it chastises all those who refrain from referring to the Qur'an and Sunnah for judgment and prefer the judgment of whatever they chose of falsehood, which befits the description of Taghut here. This is why Allah said, 4and they wish to go for judgment to the Taghut until the end of the Ayah. Allah's statement, 4tum away from you with aversion

means, they turn away from you in arrogance, just as Allah described the polytheists, ivzc& c ft s.\$&3 iWhen it is said to them: "Follow what Allah has sent down." They say : "Nay! We shall follow what we found our fathers following This is different from the conduct of the faithful believers, whom Allah describes as, ij j ft \$ ji iSj c&gx 'sf& iThe only saying of the faithful believers, when they are called, to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is that they say: "We hear and we obey Chastising the Hypocrites Chastising the hypocrites, Allah said, 4How then, when a catastrophe befalls them because of what their hands have sent forth,)> meaning, how about it if they feel compelled to join you because of disasters that they suffer due to their sins, then they will be in need of you. iThey come to you swearing by Allah, "We meant no more than goodtoill and conciliation!"\$ apologizing and swearing that they only sought goodwill and reconciliation when they referred to other than the Prophet for judgment, not that they believe in such alternative judgment, as they claim. Allah describes these people to us further in His statement, * X . . s' > *i . r .y. v 4And you see those in whose hearts there is a disease (of hypocrisy), they hurry to their friendship, saying: 'We fear"4, until.

iThen they will become regretful for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves}. At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Abu Barzah Al- Aslami used to be a soothsayer who judged between the Jews in their disputes. When some Muslims came to him to judge between them, Allah sent

down, x* Jjil Uj U [Av i l*-' iHave you not seen those (hypocrites) who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you}, until, i" We meant no more than goodwill and conciliation/" V Allah then said, 4 6& p-*i iThey (hypocrites) are those ofwhom Allah knows what is in their hearts;} These people are hypocrites, and Allah knows what is in their hearts and will punish them accordingly, for nothing escapes Allah's watch. Consequently, O Muhammad! Let Allah be sufficient for you in this regard, because He has perfect knowledge of their apparent and hidden affairs. This is why Allah said, iso turn asidefrom them (do not punish them)} meaning, do not punish them because of what is in their hearts. ibut admonish them} means, advise them against the hypocrisy and evil that reside in their hearts, i'A-k iand speak to them an effective word to reach their inner m At-Tabarani 1 1 :373

503 Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) selves} advise them, between you and them, using effective words that might benefit them. 'i&ZX \Z& it ljS& Upfi it IjZZXUte -4 'A-#- ^ i&a, Jilit 464. We se<f mo Messenger, but to be obeyed by Allah's leave. If they, when they were unjust to themselves, had come to you and begged Allah's forgiveness, and the Messenger had begged forgiveness for them, indeed, they would havefound Allah All- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 465. But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them, and find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept (them) with full submission.} The Necessity ofObeying the Messenger^ Allah said, ifpQ vt « Z'f} 4We sent no Messenger, but to be obeyed} meaning, obeying the Prophet was ordained for those to whom Allah sends the Prophet. Allah's statement, iby Allah's leave} means, "None shall obey, except by My leave," according to Mujahid. * This Ayah indicates that the Prophets are only obeyed by whomever Allah directs to obedience. In another Ayah, Allah said, iAnd Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you when you were killing them (your enemy) with His permission } (I) At-Tabari 8:516

meaning, by His command, decree, will and because He granted you superiority over them. Allah's statement, }Ifthey (hypocrites), when they had been unjust to themselves,} directs the sinners and evildoers, when they commit errors and mistakes, to come to the Messenger so that they ask Allah for forgiveness in his presence and ask him to supplicate to Allah to forgive them. If they do this, Allah will forgive them and award them His mercy and pardon. This is why Allah said, tS'ji V-*rr)} 4they would havefound Allah All-Forgiving (One Whoforgives and accepts repentance), Most Merciful}. One DoesnotBecome a BelieverUnlessHe Refersto the Messenger forJudgment and Submits to his Decisions Allah said, ii*- ^ 4But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them,} Allah swears by His Glorious, Most Honorable Self, that no one shall attain faith until he refers to the Messenger jg for judgment in all matters. Thereafter, whatever the Messenger sg commands, is the plain truth that must be submitted to inwardly and outwardly. Allah said, 4L& CJ- -4 iand find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept (them) with full submission.} meaning: they adhere to your judgment, and thus do not feel any hesitation over your decision, and they submit to it inwardly and outwardly. They submit to the Prophet's decision with total submission without any rejection, denial or dispute. Al-Bukhari recorded that TJrwah said, "Az-Zubayr quarreled with a man about a stream which both of them used for irrigation. Allah's Messenger said to Az-Zubayr,

aaaijg aa :%s@p ^s, iri 'j'pSsl , a~i V _jLL3 (ji jjjj l» ll £A J ^_J 4j\jjaj^ "V^"4 v , ^ ^ ^ ^ 0—^3UJ^ul-
aJ'j 11J^ii Ij Ovi^uiMj ^ j-^*' jj;S ^ \Ljjibjj1 ,#2jfa j6?!^j3\$St ^'02l^?3S^o0j f\$| 'ju^i ^ > ;Ujl J-d jj !*4;j
Ij Jil» J! "O Zubayr! Irrigate (your garden) first, and then let the water flow to your neighbor .» The
Ansari became angry and said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Is it because he is your cousin?' On that, the face
of Allah's Messenger jg changed color (because of anger) and said,)s+Ss -4 *1 * * r2< 4j&jij d_jjik_33
—3<_JjojlJjjLi rtJJJJ-J-j L*-'tUJl 1_r^»-l !^j U r Jl ct^ J 5- «iijU. ;di j-;f «Irrigate (your garden), O
Zubayr, and then withhold the water until it reaches the xuals (sur- rounding the palms). Then, release
the zuater to your neighbor.» So, Allah's Messenger jg gave Az-Zubayr his full right when the Ansari
made him angry. Before that, Allah's Messenger jg had given a generous judgment, beneficial for Az-
Zubayr and the Ansari. Az-Zubayr said, I think the following verse was revealed concerning that case,
£-s» &- ^ Qjj iBut no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you (O Muhammad £g)
judge in all disputes between them.y "1 > m Path Al-Bari 8 :103

Another Reason In his Tafsir, Al-Hafiz Abu Ishaq Ibrahim bin 'Abdur- Rahman bin Ibrahim bin
Duhaym recorded that Damrah narrated that two men took their dispute to the Prophet and he gave a
judgment to the benefit of whoever among them had the right. The person who lost the dispute said, "I
do not agree." The other person asked him, "What do you want then?" He said, "Let us go to Abu Bakr
As-Siddiq." They went to Abu Bakr and the person who won the dispute said, "We went to the Prophet
jg with our dispute and he issued a decision in my favor." Abu Bakr said, "Then the decision is that
which the Messenger of Allah jg issued." The person who lost the dispute still rejected the decision and
said, "Let us go to TJmar bin Al- Khattab." When they went to TJmar, the person who won the dispute
said, "We took our dispute to the Prophet jg and he decided in my favor, but this man refused to submit
to the decision." TJmar bin Al-Khattab asked the second man and he concurred. 'Umar went to his
house and emerged from it holding aloft his sword. He struck the head of the man who rejected the
Prophet's decision with the sword and killed him. Consequently, Allah revealed, iBut no, by your Lord,
they can have no faith}. ^ eg & ^ Gj5 j /« ;» ,if ijji /iV jJj J-siuJl oi pr^ y'- Ar. <iC ^ <(66. And if We
had ordered them (saying), "Kill yourselves (i.e. the innocent ones kill the guilty ones) or leave your
homes," very few of them would have done it; but if they had done what they were told, it would have
been better for them, and would have strengthened their conviction ;} Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 2 :322 . This
narration is not authentic . Damrah was not a Companion

467. And indeed We would then have bestowed upon them a great rewardfrom Ourselves.} 468. And
indeed We would have guided them to the straight way.} 469. And whoever obeys Allah and the
Messenger, then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, of the
Prophets, the Siddiqin, the martyrs, and the righteous. And how excellent these companions are!} 470.
Such is the bountyfrom Allah, and Allah is sufficient as All-Knower.} Most People DisobeyWhat They
Are Ordered Allah states that even if the people were commanded to commit what they were prohibited
from doing, most of them would not submit to this command, for their wicked nature is such that they
dispute orders. Allah has complete knowledge of what has not occurred, and how it would be if and
when it did occur. This is why Allah said, Q*it 4 ucT \$;} 4And if We had ordered them (saying), "Kill
yourselves (i.e. the innocent ones kill the guilty ones) } until the end of the Ayah. This is why Allah
said, £ ijLi 'fi} 4but if they had done what they were told,} meaning, if they do what they were
commanded and refrain from what they were prohibited, 4'4 £- S&} 4it would have been betterfor

them,} than disobeying the command and committing the prohibition, 4and would have strengthened their conviction}, stronger Tasdiq (conviction of faith), according to As-Suddi.

weak and I heard him saying, tT-yijij Si (*1^ «*>' (t*S^ Sj' g} 4”i f/ie company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, the Prophets, the true believers (Siddiqin), the martyrs and the righteous} I knew then that he was being given the choice. ” 111 Muslim recorded this Hadith.12] This Hadith explains the meaning of another Hadith; the Prophet ss said before his death; •JkVi jJ J\ [J] «0 Allah! In the Most High Company» three times, and he then died, may Allah’s best blessings be upon him.'31

The Reason Behind Revealing this Honorable Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1205–1223]

Ibn Jarir recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, “An Ansari man came to the Messenger of Allah sg while feeling sad. The Prophet said to him, Why do I see you sad?’ He said, ‘O Allah’s Prophet! I was contemplating about something.’ The Prophet sg said, What is it?’ The Ansari said, We come to you day and night, looking at your face and sitting by you. Tomorrow, you will be raised with the Prophets, and we will not be able to see you.’ The Prophet jg did not say anything, but later Jibril came down to him with this Ayah, Si*| !' Si i*'" Syi' iAnd whoever obeys Allah and the Messenger then they will be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, of the Prophets}, and the Prophet sent the good news to the Ansari man.”*4 ' This Hadith was narrated in Mursal form*5 ' from Masruq, Ikrimah, ‘Amir Ash-Shalji, Qatadah and Ar-Rabx‘ bin Anas. This is the version with the best chain of narrators. Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded it with a different chain from ‘A’ishah, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 103 121 Muslim 4:1893 131 Muslim 4:1894 At-Tabari 8 :534 * The chain of narration is missing the name ofthe Companion

“Whoever dies in f/iis state will be with the Prophets, the truthful and martyrs on the Day of Resurrection, as long as - and he raised his finger - he is not disobedient to his parents, n”111 OnlyAhmad recorded this Hadith. Greater news than this is in the authentic Hadith collected in the Sahih and Musnad compilations, in Mutawatir form, narrated by several Companions that the Messenger of Allah was asked about the person who loves a people, but his status is not close to theirs. The Messenger said, i'fS It “One is with those whom he loves . |2) Anas commented, “Muslims were never happier than with this Hadith.” In another narration, Anas said, “I love the Messenger of Allah, Abu Bakr and TJmar, and I hope that Allah will resurrect me with them, even though I did not perform actions similar to theirs.”131 Allah said, ^ jJiit iSuch is the bounty from Allah) meaning, from Allah by His mercy, for it is He who made them suitable for this, not their good deeds. iand Allah is sufficient as All-Knower), He knows those who deserve guidance and success. o-j jjj . ji oU 'jyLiti Ijji. \$2\$ \$ i! £ fit ^ 1 ft \$ di3 'j> f*4" ^ .yyj *i' <>*j Sr’J' «i' 4 ^ 4 0 4^ jif 4^ 4 472. O you who believe! Take your precautions, and either go 111 Jami'Al-Masanid was-Sunan 10:77 121 Al-Bukhari no. 6168, and MusUm 2640 Fath Al-Bari 7 :51

512 Tafstr IbtI Kathfr forth (on an expedition) in parties, or goforth all together. 472. There is certainly among you he who would linger behind. If a misfortune befalls you, he says, "Indeed Allah has favored me in that I was not present among them."} 473. But if a bounty comes to you from Allah, he would

surely say - as if there had never been ties of affection between you and him, "Oh! I wish I had been with them; then I would have achieved a great success."} 474. So fight those who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter, in the cause of Allah, and whoever fights in the cause of Allah, and is killed or gets victory, We shall bestow on him a great reward. £ The Necessity of Taking Necessary Precautions Against the Enemy Allah commands His faithful servants to take precautions against their enemies, by being prepared with the necessary weapons and supplies, and increasing the number of troops fighting in His cause. 4in parties} means, group after group, party after party, and expedition after expedition. 'Ali bin Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4and either go forth in parties} means, "In groups, expedition after expedition, 4^~r l £} 4or go forth all together}, means, all of you."121 Similar was reported from Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ad- * There is a difference of opinion over the statement translated here as; "those who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter." It could mean ; "sold the life of this world for the sake of the Hereafter", or; "purchased the life of this world at the expense of the Hereafter." So it is either an order for those of conviction to fight, or an order to those whose hearts waver in faith, who are quoted in the previous Ayah, to fight with sincerity, not for worldly matters. Most of the commentators see it as the first example. [2] At-Jabari 8 :537

Dahhak, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Khusayf Al-Jazari. Refraining from Joining Jihad is a Sign of Hypocrites Allah said, iThere is certainly among you he who would linger behind.} Mujahid and others said that this Ayah was revealed about the hypocrites.'2 Muqatil bin Hayyan said that, ^linger behind means, stays behind and does not join Jihad. It is also possible that this person himself lingers behind, while luring others away from joining Jihad. For instance, 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, may Allah curse him, used to linger behind and lure other people to do the same and refrain from joining Jihad, as Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Jarir stated. This is why Allah said about the hypocrite, that when he lingers behind from Jihad, then: }If a misfortune befalls you} death, martyrdom, or - by Allah's wisdom - being defeated by the enemy, 4V M2& * k&^ 3 ti} ihe says, "Indeed Allah has favored me that I was not present among them."} meaning, since I did not join them in battle. Because he considers this one of Allah's favors on him, unaware of the reward that he might have gained from enduring war or martyrdom, if he was killed. iBut if a bounty comes to you from Allah} such as victory, triumph and booty, m At-Jabari 8 :537-538 At-Tabari 8 :538

J tmm K3£X£» 2j, Ji\ajlaly&r l4j J tJ*4!j jii LJ bl,j iiijJ l)tgb\U'i' f } ' /'<' X • ^ • *. .*£**{ 1“ C |) ^J6 [j£j]\j Att' y4wijUJ * L/W^ 1aUjl 1 o>iJ 40j£4 -..^f i.^-V- ir r 'r^r-r^arr-i:".*: ®Qlp&%££<h%u 5 * - .> . -t . ^< ,. • • / 1 '* , V'-r""ljly)A^,4^o!j^ L^jll{^jjL:—>-b^I?Ua“b bjJj-b>8 * ft > lJ-jj ^j^bllbbi^jljtiL-ij,^ £;: #3 ^ otr i*>i")/»// T »*> <(/ie womW surely say - as 1 / f/ie had never been ties of affection be- tween you and him,} meaning, as if he was not a follower of your religion, 5\$^ 'S> 4" Oh! I wish I had been with them ; then I would have achieved a great success."} by being assigned a share of the booty and taking possession of that share. This is his ultimate aim and objective. The Encouragement to Participation in Jihad Allah then said, 4Sofight} the believer with an aversion (to fighting), Q*1' s£J< <<j iAM'M d> i those who trade the life of this world with the Hereafter} referring to those sell their religion for the meager goods of the world, and they only do this because of their disbelief and lack of faith. Allah then said; 0 *i'y Sy^ 5I1I Syf- 4 j~ij J*j} 4And whoever fights in the cause of Allah, and is killed or gets

525 Surah 4. An-Nisid' (Part-5) victory, We shall bestow on him a great reward.} meaning, whoever fights in the cause of Allah, whether he was killed or triumphant, he will earn an immense compensation and a great reward with Allah. The Two Sahihs recorded, jj ji illy; j| tjL-i JiaUtlly ill I r* JA JI* U* 1*4 "Allah has guaranteed the Mujahid in His cause that He will either bring death to him, admitting into Paradise; or, He will help him return safely to his home with whatever reward and booty he gained. jjii o'jjb *£4'j jif 4 v vi & j4-l> 'rl> j* u i+ul jt atjil \j\p3 4 vjf* 5*iij jit 4 6y~4 (jLX 4|' a? <£2if # Si^ 475. And what is wrong with you that you fight not in the cause of Allah, and for those weak, ill-treated and oppressed among men, women, and children, whose cry is: "Our Lord! Rescue us from this town whose people are oppressors; and raise for us from You one who will protect, and raise for us from You one who will help."} i76. Those who believe, fight in the cause of Allah, and those who disbelieve, fight in the cause of the Taghut. So fight against the friends of Shaytan ; ever feeble indeed is the plot of Shaytan.} Encouraging Jihad to Defend the Oppressed Allah encouraged His believing servants to perform Jihad in His cause and to strive hard to save the oppressed Muslims in Makkah, men, women and children who were restless because of having to remain there. This is why Allah said, •£* iii 14^ J\$\\} " Fath Al-Bari 6 :253 and Muslim 3 :1496

izvhose cry is: "Our Lord! Rescue us from this town}, referring to Makkah. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, ^3 ' O? ot jff)} iAtid many a toion, stronger than your town which has driven you out} Allah then describes this town, izvhose people are oppressors; and raise for us from You one who zoill protect, and raise for us from You one who will help} meaning, send protectors and helpers for us. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I and my mother were from the oppressed (in Makkah)." Allah then said, /** ^ |5,f , 'A f *• / . * > ;; p/.<- J-L-- ifM\y iThose who believe, fight in the cause of Allah, and those who disbelieve, fight in the cause of the Taghiit.} Therefore, the believers fight in obedience to Allah and to gain His pleasure, while the disbelievers fight in obedience to Shaytan. Allah then encourages the believers to fight His enemies, i^s, &? '4 k iSo fight against the friends of Shaytan; ever feeble indeed is the plot of Shaytan}. 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:103

i77. Have you not seen those who were told to hold back their hands (from fighting) and perform Saldh and give Zakdh, but when the fighting was ordained for them, behold! a section of them fear men as they fear Allah or even more. They say: "Our Lord! Why have You ordained for us fighting? Would that You granted us respite for a short period?" Say: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is (far) better for him xoho fears Allah, and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the Fatil.} 478. "Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in fortresses built up strong and high!" And if some good reaches them, they say, "This is from Allah," but if some evil befalls them, they say, "This is from you." Say: "All things are from Allah," so what is wrong with these people that they fail to understand any word?} 479. Whatever of good reaches you, is from Allah, but whatever of evil befalls you, is from yourself. And We have sent you as a Messenger to mankind, and Allah is sufficient as a Witness.} The Wish that the Order for Jihad be Delayed In the beginning of Islam, Muslims in Makkah were commanded to perform the prayer and pay some charity, so as to comfort the poor among them. They were also commanded to be forgiving and forbearing with the idolators and to observe patience with them at the time. However, they were eager and anticipating the time when they would be allowed to fight, so that they could punish their enemies. The situation at that time did not permit armed conflict for many reasons. For instance, Muslims were few at the time, compared to then- numerous

enemies. The Muslims' city was a sacred one and the most honored area on the earth, and this is why the command to fight was not revealed in Makkah. Later on when the Muslims controlled a town of their own, Al-Madinah, and had strength, power and support, Jihad was then legislated. Yet, when the command to fight was revealed, just as Muslims wished, some of them became weary and were very fearful of

facing the idolators in battle. They say: "Our Lord! Why have You ordained for us fighting? Would that You had granted us respite for a short period?" meaning, we wish that Jihad was delayed until a later time, because it means bloodshed, orphans and widows. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, "Those who believe say: 'Why is not a Surah sent down (for us)? But when a decisive is sent down, and fighting is mentioned Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf and several of his companions came to the Prophet ﷺ while in Makkah and said, "O Allah's Prophet! We were mighty when we were pagans, but when we embraced the faith, we became weak." The Prophet said, "I was commanded to pardon the people, so do not fight them." When Allah transferred the Prophet ﷺ to Al-Madinah, He commanded him to fight (the idolators), but they (some Muslims) held back. So, Allah revealed the Ayah; "Have you not seen those who were told to hold back their hands? This Hadith was collected by An-Nasa'i and Al-Hakim. Allah's statement, "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is (far) better for him who fears Allah, means, the destination of the one who with Taqwa is better for him than this life. If you and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the Fatil.} for your good deeds. Rather, you will earn your full rewards for them. This promise directs the focus of believers away from this life and makes them eager for the Hereafter, all the while encouraging them to fight in Jihad. There is No Escaping Death Allah said, "Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in fortresses built up strong and high!" meaning, you shall certainly die and none of you shall ever escape death. Allah said, "Whatever is on it (the earth) will perish}, and, "Everyone shall taste death}, and, "Atid W/c granted not to any human being immortality before you}. Therefore, every soul shall taste death and nothing can save any person from it, whether he performed Jihad or not. Everyone has an appointed time, and a limited term of life. In the illness that preceded his death, Khalid bin Al-Walid said, while in his bed, "I participated in so and so number of battles, and every part of my body sustained an injury due to a stab or a shot. Yet here I am, I die in my bed! Let not the eyes of the cowards ever taste sleep." Allah's statement, "If you are in fortresses built up strong and high!}"

him than this life. If you and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the Fatil.} for your good deeds. Rather, you will earn your full rewards for them. This promise directs the focus of believers away from this life and makes them eager for the Hereafter, all the while encouraging them to fight in Jihad. There is No Escaping Death Allah said, "Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in fortresses built up strong and high!" meaning, you shall certainly die and none of you shall ever escape death. Allah said, "Whatever is on it (the earth) will perish}, and, "Everyone shall taste death}, and, "Atid W/c granted not to any human being immortality before you}. Therefore, every soul shall taste death and nothing can save any person from it, whether he performed Jihad or not. Everyone has an appointed time, and a limited term of life. In the illness that preceded his death, Khalid bin Al-Walid said, while in his bed, "I participated in so and so number of battles, and every part of my body sustained an injury due to a stab or a shot. Yet here I am, I die in my bed! Let not the eyes of the cowards ever taste sleep." Allah's statement, "If you are in fortresses built up strong and high!}"

521 Surah 4. An-Nisa' (Part-5) Allah's statement that all things are from Him means, everything occurs by the decision and decree of Allah, and His decision shall come to pass for both the righteous and the wicked, the faithful and the disbelievers. Allah then said while addressing His Messenger ﷺ, but referring to mankind in general. "Whatever of good reaches you, is from Allah" meaning, of Allah's bounty, favor, kindness and mercy. "But whatever of evil befalls you, is from yourself.", meaning because of you and due to your actions. Similarly, Allah said, "And whatever of misfortune befalls you, it is because of what your hands have earned. And He pardons much." As-Suddi, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Zayd said that, "from yourself" means,

because of your errors. Qatadah said that, iFrom yourself} means, as punishment for you, O son of Adam, because of your sins. Allah said, iAnd We have sent you as a Messenger to mankind,} so that you convey to them Allah's commandments, what He likes and is pleased with, and what He dislikes and refuses. &m iand Allah is sufficient as a Witness.} that He has sent you. He is also Witness over you and them, having full knowledge in what you convey to them and the disbelief and rebellion with which they respond to the truth.

asaijj» {Mm AfrUa ^:lc. Jja» *Jxa ijJ@-jlab'j^s^Oi6^i0 I ^^ j f^p 4^ 5Jy*) '41° LitliVit;i^^t; fc r- *{<->f^ <'i' i't'> •< i' "X':-» ' *^5(J^ ASil I **4.w'&<<M»JUaj r-J-'r -* > -> .r.'rf&i,-" -i .< t'^ lj&ii^>tij |TO->- \ JS,^c.-ail(jOJ iit £lU -Lai iff)\ g)4 >,{-• \ t-' .-u '". •>•• ail'j Jj<j liJ)' ^6 ,*f- l*r* i/^** 'Jj~ i*\ {£'i <*>' i> j^yj 480. He who obeys the Messenger, has indeed obeyed Allah, but he who turns away, then We have not sent you as a watcher over them .> 481 . They say : "We are obedient," but when they leave you, a section of them spends all night in planning other than what you say. But Allah records their nightly (plots). So turn aside from them (do not punish them), and put your trust in Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} Obeying the Messenger is Obeying Allah Allah states that whoever obeys His servant and Messenger, Muhammad obeys Allah; and whoever disobeys him, disobeys Allah. Verily, whatever the Messenger jg utters is not of his own desire, but a revelation inspired to him. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, & Ifj iil ^ai. jii jX^ai- 'Jaj kill jdi ri :M Lj dy j*j lj^ li. !!»;;>• s U !&i

iWhoever obeys me, obeys Allah; and whoever disobeys me, disobeys Allah. Wlwever obeys the Amir (leader, ruler), obeys me; and whoever disobeys the Atmir, disobeys me. »* 1] This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahths.*21 Allah's statement. 'fSt, Uj d_>> £j} 4But he who turns away, then We have not sent you as a watcher over them.} means, do not worry about him. Your job is only to convey, and whoever obeys you, he will acquire happiness and success and you will gain a similar reward to that he earns. As for the one who turns away from you, he will gain failure and loss and you will not carry a burden because of what he does. A Hadith states, M. ! V vWhoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, will acquire guidance; and whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, will only harm himself. 3,31 The Foolishness of the Hypocrites Allah said, iThey say: "We are obedient"/. Allah states that the hypocrites pretend to be loyal and obedient. 4but when they leave you}, meaning, when they depart and are no longer with you, (»ri iijjC 4a section of them spends all night in planning other than what 111 Ahmad 1 :252 I2 ' PathAl-Bari 6 :135 and Muslim 3 :1466 Muslim 2 :594

524 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir you say}. They plot at night among themselves for other than what they pretend when they are with you. Allah said, 4But Allah records their nightly (plots).} meaning, He has full knowledge of their plots and records it through His command to His scribes, the angels who are responsible for recording the actions of the servants. This is a threat from Allah, stating that He knows what the hypocrites try to hide, their plotting in the night to defy the Messenger sg and oppose him, even though they pretend to be loyal and obedient to him. Allah will certainly punish them for this conduct. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, ilx iThey Qiypocrites) say: "We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and ive obey,"} until the end of the Ayah. Allah's statement, iSo turn aside from them} means, pardon them, be forbearing with them, do not punish them, do not expose them to the people and do not fear them. \$'3 '&'\$*} iand put your trust in Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as a

Disposer of affairs.} meaning, He is sufficient as Protector, Supporter and Helper for those who rely on Him and return to Him. A* d X* -jt <\$} VI \$ js vij% \$ IXS 482 . Do they not then consider the Qur'an carefully? Had it been from other than Allah, they would surely, have found therein contradictions in abundance}.

483. When there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people); if only they had referred it to the Messenger or to those charged with authority among them, the proper investigators would have understood it from them (directly). Had it not been for the grace and mercy of Allah upon you, you would have followed Shaytan, except a few of you.} The Qur'an is True Allah commands them to contemplate about the Qur'an and forbids them from ignoring it, or ignoring its wise meanings and eloquent words. Allah states that there are no inconsistencies, contradictions, conflicting statements or discrepancies in the Qur'an, because it is a revelation from the Most-Wise, Worthy of all praise. Therefore, the Qur'an is the truth coming from the Truth, Allah. This is why Allah said in another Ayah, 4Do they not then think deeply in the Qur'an, or are their hearts locked up (from understanding it)?} Allah then said, 4^ Jf- -Pi Cri O Sf 4Had it been from other than Allah,} meaning, had it been fraudulent and made up, as the ignorant idolators and . hypocrites assert in their hearts, {>%\$} 4they would surely, have found therein contradictions}, discrepancies and inconsistencies, 4(jifo=o) 4in abundance}. However, this Qur'an is free of shortcomings, and therefore, it is from Allah. Similarly, Allah describes those who are firmly grounded in knowledge, 4 *4# 4We believe in it, all of it is from our Lord.>(3:7) meaning, the Muhkam sections (entirely clear) and the

Mutashabih sections (not entirely clear) of the Qur'an are all true. So they understand the not entirely clear from the clear, and thus gain guidance. As for those in whose heart is the disease of hypocrisy, they understand the Muhkam from the Mutashabih; thus only gaining misguidance. Allah praised those who have knowledge and criticized the wicked. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb said that his father said that his grandfather said, "I and my brother were present in a gathering, which is more precious to me than red camels. My brother and I came and found that some of the leaders of the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg were sitting close to a door of his. We did not like the idea of being separate from them, so we sat near the room. They then mentioned an Ayah and began disputing until they raised their voices. The Messenger of Allah sg was so angry that when he went out his face was red. He threw sand on them and said to them, id] itii; jjl; ji*4ii 3] i Hj\ *JV I At \ il* 'f-i'jZ. ul i lla; iBehold, O people! This is hoiv the nations before you were destroyed, because of their disputing with their Prophets and their contradicting parts of the Books with other parts. The Qur'an does not contradict itself. Rather, it testifies to the truth of itself. Therefore, whatever of it you have knowledge in, then implement it, and whatever you do not know of it, then refer it to those who have knowledge in Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "I went to the Messenger of Allah jg one day. When we were sitting, two men disputed about an Ayah, and their voices became loud. The Prophet said, 4^ oidi U;! " Verily, the nations before you were destroyed because of their m Aljmad 2 :IS 1

527 Surah 4. An-Nisid' (Part-5) disagreements over the Boo/c. »*'* Muslim*2 * and An-Nasa'i recorded this Hadith.

The Prohibition of Disclosing Unreliable and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1223–1230]

Uninvestigated News Allah said: "When there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people) chastising those who indulge in things before being sure of their truth, disclosing them, making them known and spreading their news, even though such news might not be true at all. In the introduction to his Sahih, Imam Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet (ﷺ) said, 'Whoever narrates a Hadith while knowing it is false, then he is one of the two liars (who invents and who spreads the lie).' This is the same narration collected by Abu Dawud in the section of Adab (manners) in his Sunan. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Al-Mughlah bin Shu'bah said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) prohibited, "It was said," and, "So-and-so said." This Hadith refers to those who often convey the speech that people utter without investigating the reliability and truth of what he is disclosing. The Sahih also records, 'Whoever narrates a Hadith while knowing it is false, then he is one of the two liars (who invents and who spreads the lie).' We should mention here the Hadith of Umar bin al-Khattab collected in the Two Sahihs. When Umar was informed that Ahmad 2:192 * Muslim 4:2053 * An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 5:33 * Muslim 1:10 * Abu Dawud 5:226 * Muslim: 5 and Abu Dawud: 4992 * Muslim 1:9

the Messenger of Allah divorced his wives, he came from his house, entered the Masjid and found the people talking about this news. He could not wait and went to the Prophet ﷺ to ask him about what had truly happened, asking him, “Have you divorced your wives?” The Prophet ﷺ said, “No.” Tjmar said, “I said, Allahu Akbar and mentioned the rest of the Hadith. In the narration that Muslim collected, Tjmar said, “I asked, ‘Have you divorced them?’ He said, ‘No.’ So, I stood by the door of the Masjid and shouted with the loudest voice, ‘The Messenger of Allah did not divorce his wives.’ Then, this Ayah was revealed, **وَإِذَا جَاءَ أَحَدَهُمُ الْمَوْتُ مِنْ غَيْرِنَا فَأَدْبَارَ الْوُجُوهِ فَتَلَاوَنَ بِهِمْ وَالْمُهَلَّكَاتُ فِي الْأَيْدِي وَالْأَرْجُلِ**” (HJ0_} 1 1>; IL«J 1jCJLs j* ^ ^S»f ;4qjiq ooKvi A^V' \ >' \". * " iqs^ /i 4Wheti there comes to them some matter touching (public) safety or fear, they make it known (among the people), if only they had referred it to the Messenger or to those charged with authority among them, the proper investigators would have understood it from them (directly).} So I properly investigated that matter.”¹¹¹ m Fath Al-Bari 9 :187 and Muslim 2 : 1 105

This Ayah refers to proper investigation, or extraction of matters from their proper resources. Allah's statement, H4 •*> iyou would have followed Shaytan except a few of you.} refers to the believers, as 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas.111 cpt vJiS2 o1 ii' - »> 'Jl 'j ji' J_IS ^ Ail a; fi?r |Td^- '»ij ^ "illf jlj 1^*4 SX. «'«.* *iil ^ <i' -A".Cir*‘ Jc^ cl* Si' 6^ Xfyj 3^ 1,1* j— IjJO juwii y v ' vi'f ** ff ^ i <* *f •*'«' ^ . »»»/ •* iv < 4#4. 77ien fight in the cause ofAllah, you are not tasked (held responsible) except for yourself, and incite the believers (tofight along with you), it may be that Allah will restrain the evil might of the disbelievers. And Allah is Stronger in might and Stronger in punishing.} 485. Whosoever intercedes for a good cause, will have the reward thereof; and whosoever intercedes for an evil cause, will have a share in its burden. And Allah is Ever All-Able to do everything.} 486. When you are greeted with a greeting, greet in return with what is better than it, or (at least) return it equally. Certainly, Allah is Ever a Careful Account Taker of all things.} 487. Allah! None has the right to be worshipped but He. Surely, He will gather you together on the Day ofResurrection about which tltere is no doubt. And who is truer in statement than Allah?} AllahCommands His Messenger^ to Perform

Jihad Allah commands His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sfe, to himself fight in Jihad and not to be concerned about those who do not join Jihad. Hence Allah's statement, m At-Tabari 8 :575

4[*] iyou are not tasked (held responsible exceptfor yourself,\$ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ishaq said, "I asked Al- Bara bin 'Azib about a man who meets a hundred enemies and still fights them, would he be one of those referred to in Allah's statement, iAnd do not throw yourselves into destruction (by not spending your wealth in the cause ofAllah))}? He said, 'Allah said to His Prophet, ij&Z 'i jii 4 iThen fight in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) except for yourself, and incite the believers (to fight along with you))." Imam Ahmad recorded Sulayman bin Dawud saying that Abu Bakr bin 'Ayyash said that Abu Ishaq said, "I asked Al- Bara', If a man attacks the lines of the idolators, would he be throwing himself to destruction?" He said, 'No because Allah has sent His Messenger and commanded him. 4&Z 4jp} iThen fight in the cause of Allah, you are not tasked (held responsible) exceptfor yourself,} That Ayah is about spending [in Allah's cause]."* 11 Inciting the Believers to Fight Allah said, iand incite the believers} to fight, by encouraging them and strengthening their resolve in this regard. For instance, the Prophet said to the believers at the battle of Badr, while organizing their lines, 111 Ahmad 4:281

532Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) «Stand up and march forth to a Paradise, as wide as the heavens and Earth .a There are many Hadiths that encourage Jihad. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah Si said, j k j kiL aJ j A\ *j>j\ jt ji jii ^ i ki»Ji iU-jj ji kii iWhoever believes in Allah and His Messenger, offers prayer, pays the Zakdlt and fasts the month ofRamadan, will rightfully be granted Paradise by Allah, no matter whether he migrates in Allah's cause or remains in the land where he is bom. » The people said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Shall we acquaint the people with this good news?' He said, kkil kill UopI 'Jr'ji iiU c»Jl^ jj ^j <*>' i^jSii) »uiji «iiJl 'frJi oj ijl^Jl u'ji iki^Jl «Paradise has one hundred grades which Allah has reserved for the Mujahidin who fight in His cause, the distance between each two grades is like the distance between the heaven and the Earth. So, when you ask Allah, ask for Al-Firdaws, which is the best and highest part of Paradise, above it is the Throne of the Most Betieficent (Allah) and from it originate the rivers of Paradise. »|2 ' There are various narrations for this Hadith from TJbadah,13 Mu'adh,*4 * and Abu Ad-Darda'. Abu Said Al-Khudri narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *1 J 4 1—* ^5 j i Urfi k Uj kiiL j jj* !A.-W-* lil Ud Pq «0 Abu Sa'id! Whoever accepts Allah as his Lord, Islam as his Muslim 3:1510 m FathAl-Bari 6:14 [31 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :237 ' Ibn Majah 2 :1448

religion and Muhammad as the Prophet, then he would rightfully acquire Paradise .» Abu Said liked these words and said, "O Allah's Messenger! Repeat them for me." The Prophet jg repeated his words, then said. ^ U <il 'ji j *And (there is) another deed far which Allah raises the servant a hundred grades in Paradise, between each two grades is the distance behoeen heaven and Earth. Abu Said said, "What is it, O Allah's Messenger ?" He said, «Jihad in Allah's cause.* This Hadith was collected by Muslim. Allah's statement, & jX Jfc J lit J±} iit may be that Allah zuill restrain the evil might of the disbelievers.> means, by your encouraging them to fight, their resolve will be strengthened to meet the enemy in battle, to defend Islam and its people and to endure and be patient against the enemy. Allah's statement, xiVj JISI 4And Allah is Stronger in might and Stronger in punishing.} means, He is able over them in this life and the Hereafter, just as He said in another Ayah, 'k.JfC. iJD jCij pfa. *i' iGi 4But

if it had been Allah's will, He Himself could certainly have punished them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some of you with others} (47:4). 111 Muslim 3:1501

533 Surah 4. An-Nisr' (Part-5) Interceding for a Good or an Evil Cause Allah said, 4Whoever intercedes for a good cause, will have the reward thereof;} meaning, whoever intercedes in a matter that results, will acquire a share in that good. produces good iAnd whoever intercedes for an evil cause, will have a share in its burden.} meaning, he will carry a burden due to what resulted from his intercession and intention. For instance, it is recorded in the Sahih that the Prophet jg said, U jUJ Jjlp <1>1 1 «Intercede and you will gain a reward of it. Yet, Allah shall decide whatever He wills by the words of His Prophet .»m Mujahid bin Jabr said, “This Ayah was revealed about the intercession of people on behalf of each other.”121 Allah then said. 4)^ }&\$& iif j^j} iAnd Allah is Ever Muqit over everything.} Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ata’, ‘Atiyah, Qatadah and Matar Al-Warraaq said that, iMuqit means, “Watcher.”131 Mujahid said that Muqit means, Witness’, and in another narration, ‘Able to do.’*41 Returning the Salam, With a Better Salam Allah said, Fath Al-Bari 3 :35 At-Jabari 8:581 At-Jabari 8 : 583 At-Jabari 8:583.

r*r60 iWhen you are greeted with a greeting, greet in return with

what is better than it, or (at least) return it equally

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1230–1239]

meaning, if the Muslim greets you with the Salam, then return the greeting with a better Salam, or at least equal to the Salam that was given. Therefore, the better Salam is recommended, while returning it equally is an obligation. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Raja’ Al-‘Utaridi said that Imran bin Husayn said that a man came to the Messenger of Allah and said, “As-Salamu ‘Alaykum”. The Prophet returned the greeting, and after the man sat down he said, “Ten.” Another man came and said, “As-Salamu ‘Alaykum wa RahmatuUdh, O Allah’s Messenger.” The Prophet jg returned the greeting, and after the man sat down he said, “Twenty.” Then another man came and said, “As-Salamu ‘Alaykum wa Rahmatullah wa Barakatuh.” The Prophet returned the greeting, and after the man sat down he said, “Thirty.”111 This is the narration recorded by Abu Dawud. At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa’i and Al-Bazzar also recorded it. At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib”. There are several other Hadiths on this subject from Abu Said, ‘Ali, and Sahl bin Hanif.’21 When the Muslim is greeted with the full form of Salam, he is obliged to return the greeting equally. As for Ahl Adh-Dhimmah the Salam should not be initiated nor should the greeting be added to when returning their greeting. Rather, as recorded in the Two Sahih their greeting is returned to them equally. Ibn Umar narrated that the Messenger of Allah sg said, : jii istdU fun jjZ^ fidU fJL. «When the Jews greet you, one of them would say, 'As-Sdmu ‘Alayka (death be unto you).' Therefore, say, Wa ‘Alayka (and the same to you).» * Ahmad 4:439 I2 ' Abu Dawud 5 :379 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :463 , KashfAl-Astar2 :418 Non-Muslims under Muslim control 141 Fath Al-B&ri 12 :293 and Muslim 4 :1706

In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, “Do not initiate greeting the Jews and Christians with the Saldm, and when you pass by them on a road, force them to its narrowest pathM Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah

sg said, «Bi/ He in Whose Hand is my soul! You will not enter Paradise until you believe, and you will not believe until you love each other. Should I direct you to an action that would direct you to love each other? Spread the Saldm among yourselvesV2^ Allah said, is* *L4 H iAllah! none has the right to be worshipped but He} informing that He is singled out as the sole God of all creation. Allah then said, iU css jj iSurely, He will gather you together on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt.} swearing that He will gather the earlier and latter generations in one area, rewarding or punishing each person according to his or her actions. Allah said, ji j*j} iAnd who is truer in statement than Allah?} meaning, no one utters more truthful statements than Allah, in His promise, warning, stories of the past and information of what is to come; there is no deity worthy of worship nor Lord except Him. 111 Muslim 4:1707 121 Abu Dawud 5 :378

J 'rrr, fTT.J r" f-T ^ h -s> '\$&c. ^LS.J ill iti JJj i^u jl o' pijjii j^/*ti- &i \%&\$ fi \$\$s 4 4 ^ Ji i;t c;^ f^t; af^ s.>>:s^ ^ i4i £iis^ ^ &i 5® #& ;J 4:*\EJ iiOi^ -ia G£ &&1; 4SS. Then what is the matter with you that you are divided into two parties about the hypocrites? Allah has cast them back because of what they have earned. Do you want to guide him whom Allah has made to go astray? And he whom Allah has made to go astray, you luill neverfindfor him a way.} 489. They wish that you reject faith, as they have rejected, and thus that you all become equal (like one another). So take not Awliydh'from them, till they emigrate in the way ofAllah. But if they turn back, take (Iwld of) them and kill them wherever you find them, and take neither Awliydh ' nor helpers from them.} 490. Except those who join a group, between you and whom there is a treaty (of peace), or those who approach you with their breasts restraining from fighting you as well as fighting their own people. Had Allah willed, indeed He would have given them power over you, and they would have fought you. So, if they withdraw from you, and fight not against you, and offer you peace, then Allah has made no way for you against them.} 491. You will find others that wish to lurue security from you and securityfrom their people. Every time they are sent back to Fitnah, they yield thereto. If they withdraw notfrom you, nor offer you peace, nor restrain their hands, take (Itold of) them and kill them wherever you Thaqiftumiihum . In their case, We have provided you with a clear warrant against them.}

Censuring the Companions for Disagreeing over the Hypocriteswho Returned to Al-Madinah BeforeUhud Allah criticizes the believers for disagreeing over the hypocrites. There are conflicting opinions over the reason behind revealing this Ayah. Imam Ahmad recorded that Zayd bin Thabit said that Messenger of Allah jg marched towards Uhud. However, some people who accompanied him went back to Al-Madinah, and the Companions of the Messenger of Allah #3 divided into two groups concerning them, one saying they should be killed and the other objecting. Allah sent down, iThen what is the matter ivith you that you are divided into tivo parties about the hypocrites?} The Messenger of Allah said, She (Al-Madinah) is Taybah, and she expels filth, just as the billozv expels rust from iron.^ l] The Two Sahihs also recorded this Hadith. [2] Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah was revealed about some people in Makkah who said they embraced Islam, yet they gave their support to the idolators. One time, theses people went out of Makkah to fulfill some needs and said to each other, "If we meet the Companions of Muhammad, there will be no harm for us from their side." When the believers got news that these people went out of Makkah, some of them said, "Let us march to these cowards and kill them, because they support your enemy against you." However, another group from the believers said, "Glory be to Allah! Do you kill a people who say as you have said, just because they

did not perform Hijrah or leave their land? Is it allowed to shed their blood and confiscate their money in this case?" So they divided to two groups, while the Messenger jg was with them, and did not prohibit either group from Ahmad 5:184 Fath Al-Bari4:115 and Muslim 2 :1007

539 Surah 4. Ati-Nisd' (Part-5) 4So take not Awliyid' from them, till they emigrate in the way of Allah. But if they turn back,} if they abandon Hijrah, as Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas. As-Suddi said that this part of the Ayah means, "If they make their disbelief public." Combatants and Noncombatants Allah excluded some people; iExcept tlwse who join a group, between you and whom there is a treaty (ofpeace), } meaning, except those who join and take refuge with a people with whom you have a pact of peace, or people of Dhimmah, then treat them as you treat the people with whom you have peace. This is the saying of As-Suddi, Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir. 121 In his Sahih, Al-Bukhari recorded the story of the treaty of Al-Hudaybiyyah, where it was mentioned that whoever liked to have peace with Quraysh and conduct a pact with them, then they were allowed. Those who liked to have peace with Muhammad and his Companions and enter a pact with them were allowed.13 ' It was reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that this Ayah was later abrogated by Allah's statement, y •> >\ iThen when the Sacred Months have passed, kill the idolators wherever you find them}141 Allah said, ior those who approach you with their breasts restraining referring to another type of people covered by the exclusion from fighting. They are those who approach the Muslims with 111 At-Tabari 9 :17 ' At-Tabari 9 : 19 ' Fath Al-Bari 5 :388 and Ahmad 4 :325 ' At-Tabari 9 : 18

540 Tafsir Ibn Kathir hesitation in their hearts because of their aversion to fighting the Muslims. They do not have the heart to fight with the Muslims against their own people. Therefore, they are neither with nor against Muslims. 4Had Allah willed, indeed He would have given them power over you, and they would have fought you .} meaning, it is from Allah's mercy that He has stopped them from fighting you. 4p\ >fi\ figg fi)%\ \$} 4So, if they withdraw from you, and fight not against you, and offer you peace, meaning, they revert to peace. ithen Allah has opened no way for you against them}, you do not have the right to kill them, as long as they take this position. This was the position of Banu Hashim (the tribe of the Prophet 5§), such as Al-'Abbas, who accompanied the idolaters in the battle of Badr, for they joined the battle with great hesitation. This is why the Prophet commanded that Al- 'Abbas not be killed, but only captured. Allah's statement, 4You will find others that wish to have security from you and security from their people.} refers to a type of people who on the surface appear to be like the type we just mentioned. However, the intention of each type is different, for the latter are hypocrites. They pretend to be Muslims with the Prophet and his Companions, so that they could attain safety with the Muslims for their blood, property and families. However, they support the idolaters in secret and worship what they worship, so that they are at peace with them also. These people have secretly sided with the idolaters, just as Allah described them, 4i rji^ i*. i0 4But when they are alone with their ShayaHn, they say : "Truly, we

are with you."}. In this Ayah, Allah said, iP 3l 'jij ^ iEvery time they are sent back to Fitnah, they yield thereto.} meaning, they dwell in Fitnah. As-Suddi said that the Fitnah mentioned here refers to ShirfcJ * Ibn Jarir recorded that Mujahid said that the Ayah was revealed about a group from Makkah who used to go to the Prophet jg [in Al-Madlnah] pretending to be Muslims. However, when they went back to Quraysh, they reverted to worshipping idols. They wanted to be at peace with both sides. Allah

commanded they should be fought against, unless they withdraw from combat and resort to peace. This is why Allah said, if they withdraw from you, nor offer you peace} meaning, revert to peaceful and complacent behavior, nor restrain their hands} refrain from fighting you, i.e. 'A - \S' < I 111 At-Tabari 9 :28 At-Tabari 9 :27

take (hold of) them}, capture them, and kill them wherever you find them, In their case, We have provided you with a clear warrant against them}, meaning an unequivocal and plain warrant. >-A> bl** - o*j J otj-l ^s} >>j f& 'yxc. ja 'yiiSu jl 'fy 5^ idiJ ijij pL.ji ^ ^ oi5 ^ ^ -4^ Cr*J <Sf:ty£ Cfe ;i li.1j £3;^& 4^ .5^^ «Sit oi •*?<" -'ST-r 492. It is not for a believer to kill a believer except by mistake; and whosoever kills a believer by mistake, he must set free a believing slave and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family unless they remit it. If the deceased belonged to a people at war with you and he was a believer, the freeing of a believing slave (is prescribed) ; and if he belonged to a people with whom you have a treaty of mutual alliance, then compensation (blood money) must be paid to his family, and a believing slave must be freed. And whoso finds this beyond his means, he must fast for two consecutive months in order to seek repentance from Allah. And Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All- Wise.} 493. And whoever kills a believer intentionally, his recompense is Hell to abide therein; and the wrath and the curse of Allah are upon him, and a great punishment is prepared for him.} The Ruling Concerning Killing a Believer by Mistake Allah states that the believer is not allowed to kill his believing brother under any circumstances. In the Two Sahths,

it is recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah m said, jjUJl ojJ j 'The blood of a Muslim who testifies that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that I am the Messenger of Allah, is sacred, except in three instances. (They are :) life for life, the married adulterer, and whoever reverts from the religion and abandons the Jamd'ah (community of the faithful believers)V When one commits any of these three offenses, it is not up to ordinary citizens to kill him or her, because this is the responsibility of the Muslim Leader or his deputy. Allah said, 4&L iexcept by mistake There is a difference of opinion concerning

the reason behind revealing this part of the Ayah. Mujahid and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1239–1243]

others said that it was revealed about 'Ayyash bin Abi RabTah, Abu Jahl's half brother, from his mother's side, Asma' bint Makhrabah. 'Ayyash killed a man called Al-Harith bin Yazid Al- 'Amiri, out of revenge for torturing him and his brother because of their Islam. That man later embraced Islam and performed Hijrah, but 'Ayyash did not know this fact. On the Day of the Makkan conquest, 'Ayyash saw that man and thought that he was still a disbeliever, so he attacked and killed him. Later, Allah sent down this AyahJ2 ' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah was revealed about Abu Ad-Darda' because he killed a man after he embraced the faith, just as Abu Ad-Darda' held the sword above him. When this matter was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah jg, Abu Ad-Darda' said, "He only said that to avert death." The Prophet said to him, «4-li je- C-iLi ^ Fath. Al-Bari 12 :209 and Muslim 3 :1302 At-Tabari 9 :32

Have you opened his heart? The basis for this story is in the Sahih, but it is not about Abu Ad-Darda'. Allah said, and whoever kills a believer by mistake, he must set free a believing slave and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family} thus, ordaining two requirements for murder by mistake. The first requirement is the Kaffarah (fine) for the great sin that has been committed, even if it was a mistake. The Kaffarah is to free a Muslim slave, not a non-Muslim slave. Imam Ahmad recorded that a man from the Ansar said that he brought a slave and said, "O Messenger of Allah! I have to free a believing slave, so if you see that this slave is a believer, I will free her." The Messenger of Allah ﷺ asked her, "Do you testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah?" She said, "Yes." He asked her, "Do you testify that I am the Messenger of Allah?" She said, "Yes." He asked, "Do you believe in Resurrection after death?" She said, "Yes."

The Prophet ﷺ said, "Whoever frees a believing slave, Allah will forgive him." This is an authentic chain of narration, and not knowing the name of the Ansari Companion does not lessen its authenticity. Allah's statement, At-Jabari 9:34 121 Ahmad 3:451

and submit compensation (blood money) to the deceased's family is the second obligation which involves the killer and the family of the deceased, who will receive blood money as compensation for their loss. The compensation is only obligatory for the one who possesses one of five; as Imam Ahmad, and the Sunan compilers recorded from Ibn Mas'ud. He said; "Allah's Messenger determined that the Diyah (blood money) for unintentional murder is twenty camels which entered their fourth year, twenty camels which entered their fifth year, twenty camels which entered their second year, and twenty camels which entered their third year." This is the wording of An-Nasal. This Diyah is required from the elders of the killer's tribe, not from his own money. In the Two Sahih, it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "Two women from Hudhayl quarreled and one of them threw a stone at the other and killed her and her unborn fetus. They disputed before the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and he decided that the Diyah of the fetus should be to free a male or a female slave. He also decided that the Diyah of the deceased is required from the elders of the killer's tribe." This Hadith indicates that in the case of what appears to be intentional murder, the Diyah is the same as that for killing by virtual mistake. The former type requires three types of Diyah, just like intentional murder, because it is somewhat similar to intentional murder. Al-Bukhari recorded in his Sahih that 'Abdullah bin Umar said, "The Messenger of Allah sent Khalid bin Al-Walid to Banu Jadhimah and he called them to Islam, but they did not know how to say, 'We became Muslims.' They started saying, 'Saba'na, Saba'na (we became Sabians). Khalid started killing them, and when this news was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, he raised his hands and said, 'O Allah! I declare my innocence before You of what Khalid did.' An-Nasal no. 4799, Ahmad 1:384, Abu Dawud no. 4545, At-Tirmidhi no. 1386, and Ibn Majah no. 363 121 Fath Al-Bari 12:263 and Muslim 3:1309

it - Sc. iiil ^ iji *2?> 4to seek repentance from Allah. And Allah is Ever All- Knowing, All-Wise .} means, this is how the one who kills by mistake can repent, he fasts two consecutive months if he does not find a slave to free. IIX dM} iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise}, we mentioned the explanation of this before.

Warning Against Intentional Murder

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1243–1255]

After Allah mentioned the ruling of unintentional murder, He mentioned the ruling for intentional murder. Allah said, —ty j— 4And whoever kills a believer intentionally,} This Ayah carries a stern warning and promise for those who commit so grave a sin that it is mentioned along with Shirk in several Ayat of Allah’s Book. For instance, in Surat Al- Furqan, Allah said, % ill p\$ tfZ % >r. & 4And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause}. Allah said, 4Say : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from: Join not anything in worship with Him.} [6:151]. There are many Ayat and Hadiths that prohibit murder. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn Mas’ud said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, iBlood offenses are the first disputes to be judged between the people on the Day ofResurrection .» 111 Path Al-Bari 1 1 :402 and Muslim 3 :1304

In a Hadith that Abu Dawud recorded, ‘Ubadah bin As-Samit states that the Messenger of Allah jg said, us wjUsi liu us p u liii jiji “The believer will remain unburdened in righteousness as long as he does not shed prohibited blood. When he sheds forbidden blood, he will become burdened.»[51 Another Hadith, states, j>-j <«i jit ciji j\jfo “The destruction of this earthly life is less significant before Allah than killing a Muslim man (or woman) .”[2 ' Will the Repentance of those who Commit Intentional Murder, be Accepted? Ibn ‘Abbas held the view that the repentance of one who intentionally murders a believer, will not be accepted. Al- Bukhari recorded that Ibn Jubayr said, “The people of knowledge of Al-Kufah differed on this subject, I traveled to Ibn ‘Abbas to ask him about it. He said, This Ayah, y >\T'r • 4 , rr 4And whoever kills a believer intentionally, his recompense is Hell> was the last revealed [on this subject] and nothing abrogated it.” ’ Muslim ' and An-Nasa'i *S| also recorded it. However, the majority of scholars of the earlier and later generations said that the killer’s repentance can be accepted. If he repents, and goes back to Allah humbly, submissively, and performing righteous deeds, then Allah will change his evil deeds into good deeds and compensate the deceased for his loss by rewarding him for his suffering. Allah said, Abu Dawud no. 4270, Jami'Al-Masanid was-Sunan 7 : 143 Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 4 :652 Path Al-Bdri 8 :106 Muslim 4:2318 ISI An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :326

}And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah}, until, 4Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds}. The Ayah we just mentioned should not be considered abrogated or only applicable to the disbelievers [who become Muslim], for this contradicts the general, encompassing indications of the Ayah and requires evidence to support it. Allah knows best. Allah said, 4?i' ij~j Oi i>l»—* V I iSay: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy ofAllah}. This Ayah is general, covering all types of sins, including Kufr, Shirk, doubt, hypocrisy, murder, sin, and so forth. Therefore, everyone who repents sincerely from any of these errors, then Allah will forgive him. Allah said, a c *X& d #5 -t& l\} 4 Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but Heforgives except that (anything else) to whom He wills}. This Ayah is general and includes eveiy sin except Shirk, and it has been mentioned in this Surah, both after this Ayah and before it, in order to encourage hope in Allah, and Allah knows best. It is confirmed in the Two Sahihs, that an Israeli killed one hundred people then he asked a scholar, “Is it possible for me to repent?” So he replied, “What is there that would prevent you from repentance?” So

he told him to go to another land where Allah was worshipped. He began to emigrate to it but died on the way, and the angel of mercy was the one to take him. ' Although this Hadith is about an Israeli, it is even more suitable for the Muslim community that their repentance be accepted. Indeed, Allah relieved Muslims (i) Fath Al-Bari 6 :59 1 and Muslim 4 :2 1 18

from the burdens and restrictions that were placed on the Jews, and He sent our Prophet ﷺ with the easy Hanifiyyah way (Islamic Monotheism). As for the honorable Ayah, — o*if 4And whoever kills a believer intentionally}, Abu Hurayrah and several among the Salaf said that this is his punishment, if Allah decides to punish him. And this is the case with every threat that is issued for every sin. For instance, there could be good deeds that this person has done that would prevent him from being punished for that, and Allah knows best. Even if the murderer inevitably enters the Fire - as Ibn ‘Abbas stated because his repentance was not accepted, or he did not have good deeds to save him, he will not remain there for eternity, but only for a long time. There are Mutawatir Hadiths stating that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 9^4 1 'j*. v3 tAA ij “Whoever has the least speck of faith in his heart shall ultimately depart the Fire, s' 1 ' 0 -A >j\> % jt j k ££ A Ayclf \it.ji SJJ & 'if if J4 tk pl^= 494. O you who believe! When you go (to fight) in the cause of Allah, verify (the truth), and say not to anyone who greets you : “You are not a believer;” seeking the perishable goods of the worldly life. There is much more benefit with Allah. Even as he is now, so were you yourselves before, till Allah conferred on you His Favors, therefore, be cautious in discrimination. Allah is Ever Well-Aware of what you do.} Greeting with the Salam is a Sign of Islam Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ikrimah said that Ibn ‘Abbas Al-Bukhari no. 44, 7509 and At-Tirmidhi no. 2598.

said, “A man from Bani Sulaym, who was tending a flock of sheep, passed by some of the Companions of the Prophet ﷺ and said Salam to them. They said (to each other), ‘He only said Salam to protect himself from us.’ Then they attacked him and killed him. They brought his sheep to the Prophet ﷺ, and this Ayah was revealed, 4!£" 40 you who believe!}, until the end of the Ai/ah.” At-Tirmidhi recorded this in his (chapter on) Tafslr, and said, “This Hadith is Hasan, and it is also reported from Usamah bin Zayd.”121 Al-Hakim also recorded it and said, “Its chain is Sahih, but they did not collect it.”131 Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas commented; iand say not to anyone who greets you : "You are not a believer;"}, “A man was tending his sheep and the Muslims caught up with him. He said, ‘As-Salamu ‘Alaykum.’ However, they killed him and took his sheep. Allah revealed the Ayah; r^i. W^^ % 4And say not to anyone who greets you : "You are not a believer; seeking the perishable goods of the worldly life}.” Ibn ‘Abbas said; “The goods of this world were those sheep.” And he recited, iPeace> Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Qa‘qa‘ bin Abdullah bin Abi Hadrad narrated that his father ‘Abdullah bin Abi Hadrad said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ sent us to (the area of) Idam. I rode out with a group of Muslims that included Abu Qatadah, 111 Ahmad 1 :272 [2] Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :386 131 Al-Hakim 2 : 235 141 Path Al-Bari 8 :107

Al-Harith bin Rab'I and Muhallam bin Juthamah bin Qays. We continued on until we reached the area of Idam, where ‘Amr bin Al-Adbat Al-Ashjal passed by us on his camel. When he passed by us he said Salam to us, and we did not attack him. Because of some previous problems with him, Muhallam bin Juthamah killed him and took his camel. When we went back to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and told him what had happened, a part of the Qur'an was revealed about us, 4 Gi ip: 40 you who believe! When you

go (to fight) in the cause of Allah}, until, 4Well-Aware}.” Only Ahmad recorded this Hadith. [1] Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said to Al-Miqdad, »jl 51^ 1^1® t ^ ^ ^ p ^ ' s | f ^ | ^ fjA a£Lw CjI “You killed a believing man who hid his faith toith disbelieving people, after he had announced his faith to you . Remember that you used to hide yourfaith in Makkah before . Al-Bukhari recorded this shorter version without a complete chain of narrators.^ However a longer version with a connected chain of narrators has also been recorded. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Messenger of Allah sent a military expedition under the authority of Al-Miqdad bin Al-Aswad and when they reached the designated area, they found the people had dispersed. However, a man with a lot of wealth did not leave and said, ‘I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah.’ Yet, Al-Miqdad killed him, and a man said to him, You killed a man after he proclaimed: “There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. By Allah I will mention what you did to the Prophet jg.’ When they went back to the Messenger of I 1 ' Ahmad 6:11 . This narration is not authentic. Al-Bukhari no . 6866

Allah, they said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Al-Miqdad killed a man who testified that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah.’ He said, % iJil iij V c-iat U oIjjLJI • Sitl ill «Summon Al-Miqdad before me. 0 Miqdad! Did you kill a man who proclaimed, “There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah?” What woidd you do when you face, “There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah tomorrow?” Allah then revealed; ^==£-1], jll j fZfj \jS\ j&at 4r£z {St At- «J\ JLiJ* IlijJ' \y~>S\ 40 you who believe! When you go (to fight) in the cause of Allah, verify (the truth), and say not to anyone ivho greets you : ”You are not a believer;” seeking the perishable goods of the worldly life. There are much more profits and booties with Allah. Even as he is now, so were you yourselves before till Allah conferred on you His Favors, therefore, be cautious in discrimination The Messenger of Allah jg said to Al-Miqdad, 1 azILsj jLiS ^ ifro fjA <!X<u wJLLlJl «He was a believing man who hid his faith among disbelieving people, and he announced his faith to you, but you killed him, although you used to hide yourfaith before, in MakkahX^ Allah’s statement, 4 4)1 4There is much more benefit with Allah. means, better than what you desired of worldly possessions which made you kill the one who greeted you with the Salam m Majma'Az-Zawa'id 7 :9

smm imm //_ */•/^ *, ./ | *" |<#i/ ^ ^ <*< I^iyOyI> j(Uy ~: ^g, L • ^-.3*° 'i_i^cl)’ -i^i>-J \$\$\$K#j //{f ,< i J/ >jT> > " -' < < ,!" and pronounced his faith to you. Yet, you ignored all this and accused him of hypocrisy, to acquire the gains of this life. However, the pure wealth with Allah is far better than what you acquired. Allah’s statement, A3 « pLfe- ^SS> 4^SCl£ ill ^so were yow yourselves before, till Allah con- ferred on you His Favors .) means, beforehand, you used to be in the same situation like this person who hid his faith from his people. We mentioned the relevant Hadiths above. Allah said, / . 5 ** - •>? • j-» 4And remember when you werewere and were reckoned weak in the land}. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr commented about Allah’s statement, 4A3 j: ^ iso were you yourselves before>, “You used to hide your faith, just as this shepherd hid his faith.” Allah said, i\%Z) *** ‘Abdur-RazzHq 1 :170

4therefore, be cautious in discrimination}, then said, 4Allah is Ever Well-Aware of what you do.} and this part of the Ayah contains a threat and a warning, as Said bin Jubayr stated. 4 Ji ojijisi' isf2 y} .i* '4** >*\ //<' ,^5> / “IJf • { .tz • .".t f <l>l ^ J* 48 / •,- • ,*,< i .fA* %i f s.V // // *z/ *^^*.1/ 1.^ />f z •Jff

<z z /'>!? ^.'vU^5>j ^yti- ittl o»> <c* (/_» 495. Not e^wa/ are f/iOSE 0/ the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled, and those who strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives. Allah has preferred in grades those who strive hard and fight with their wealth and their lives above those who sit (at home). Unto each, Allah has promised good (Paradise), but Allah has preferred those who strive hard and fight, above those who sit (at home), by a huge reward.} 496. Degrees of (higher) grades from Him, and forgiveness and mercy. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} The Mujahid and those Who Do not Join Jihad are Not the Same, [and Jihad is Ford. Kifayah) li] Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara' said, "When the Ayah, 4j&iP' Si sf—i y} 4Not equal are those of the believers who sit (at home),} was revealed, the Messenger of Allah jg called Zayd and commanded him to write it. Then, Ibn Umm Maktum came and mentioned that he was blind. Allah revealed, 4fj&^ j^} 4except those who are disabled (by injury or are blind or lame)}.TM This part of the heading was added to the English publication for the benefit of the reader, since Ibn Kathlr makes this statement here 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :108

Al-Bukhari recorded that Sahl bin Sa'd As-Sa'di said, "I saw Marwan bin Al-Hakam sitting in the Masjid. I came and sat by his side. He told us that Zayd bin Thabit told him that Allah's Messenger jg dictated this Ayah to him, 4^ 4 jj- Irt \Sf~* V> equal are those of the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled, and those who strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah Ibn Umm Maktum came to the Prophet jg as he was dictating that very Ayah to me. Ibn Umm Maktum said, 'O Allah's Messenger! By Allah, if I had power, I would surely take part in Jihad.' He was a blind man. So Allah sent down revelation to His Messenger while his thigh was on mine and it became so heavy for me that I feared that my thigh would be broken. That ended after Allah revealed, iexcept those xvho are disabled\$*." This was recorded by Al- Bukhari. At-Tirmidhi recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4)1 Ljitjill 4} Sj \Sy^4. 't} iNot equal are those of the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled}. refers to those who did not go to the battle of Badr and those who went to Badr. When the battle of Badr was about to occur, Abu Ahmad bin Jahsh and Ibn Umm Maktum said, *We are blind, O Messenger of Allah! Do we have an excuse?' The Ayah, 4Not equal are those of the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled was revealed. Allah made those who fight, above those who sit in their homes not hindered by disability. ."..tLkf- til ibut Allah has preferred those who strive hard and fight, above m Fath Al-Bari 8:108

those who sit (at home), by a huge reward. Degrees of (higher) grades from Him}, above the believers who sit at home without a disability hindering them." This is the wording recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said, "Hasan Ghatib-"1 ' 1 Allah's statement, y /• - •/ .{v J* Sy—i ^f 4Not equal are those of the believers luho sit (at home),} this is general. Soon after, the revelation came down with, 4except those ivho are disabled}. So whoever has a disability, such as blindness, a limp, or an illness that prevents them from joining Jihad, they were not compared to the Mujahidin who strive in Allah's cause with their selves and wealth, as those who are not disabled and did not join the Jihad were. In his Sahih, Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, olj Jt a ~~~a J-f La OJUJL jl 0 aThere are people who remained in Al-Madinah, who were with you in even/ march you marched and every valley you crossed .» They said, "While they are still in Al-Madinah, O Messenger of Allah?" He said, * • >!, > > , a . •j-Wl (*-f—r*- j**' «Yes . Only their disability hindered them (from joining you).^2 \ Allah said, fcP-' & JS }Unto each, Allah has promised good meaning, Paradise and

tremendous rewards. This Ayah indicates that Jihad is not Fard on each and every individual, but it is Fard Kifayah Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :388 121 Fath Al-Bari 7 :732

(which is a collective duty). Allah then said, ibut Allah has preferred those who strive hard and fight, above those who sit (at home), by a huge reward}. Allah mentions what He has given them rooms in Paradise, along with His forgiveness and the descent of mercy and blessing on them, as a favor and honor from Him. So He said; iDegrees of (higher) grades from Him, and forgiveness and mercy. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.}. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^ l* < u> Al iiU a!>J| Jp j[» 0 tUUI jZLS "There are a hundred grades in Paradise that Allah has prepared for the Mujahidin in His cause, between each tivo grades is the distance between heaven and Earth. ij5u JiVi 4 ^ fjltt ^JUi jCJij) 'jf # ^ 4 if^ a 4# •£ £; j'd ^ Jf- -wi ^>1' 4j-*i -*LkjS ji>' 0^ 'fix j; jyi iz.j Ijfi ij»t 497. Verily, as for those whom the angels take (in death) while they are wronging themselves, they (angels) say (to them): "In what (condition) were you?" They reply: "We were weak and oppressed on the earth." They (angels) say: "Was not the earth of Allah spacious enough for you to emigrate therein?" Such men will find their abode in Hell - what an evil destination!} 495. Except the weak ones among men, women and children HI Muslim 3 :1501

559Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) who cannot devise a plan, nor are they able to direct their way> 499. These are they whom Allah is likely to forgive them, and Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving 4100. He who emigrates in the cause of Allah, will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by. And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reward is then surely incumbent upon Allah. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful

The Prohibition of Residing Among the Disbelievers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1255–1263]

While Able to Emigrate Al-Bukhari recorded that Muhammad bin ‘Abdur-Rahman, Abu Al-Aswad, said, “The people of Al-Madinah were forced to prepare an army (to fight against the people of Ash-Sham during the Khilafah of Abdullah bin Az-Zubayir at Makkah), and I was enlisted in it. Then I met ‘Ikrimah, the freed slave of Ibn ‘Abbas, and informed him (about it), and he forbade me strongly from doing so (i.e., to enlist in that army), and then he said to me, Ibn ‘Abbas told me that some Muslims used to go out with the idolators increasing the size of their army against the Messenger of Allah jfe. Then, an arrow would hit one of them and kill him, or he would be struck on his neck (with a sword) and killed, and Allah sent down the Ayah, iVerily, as for those whom the angels take (in death) while they are wronging themselves Ad-Dahhak stated that this Ayah was revealed about some hypocrites who did not join the Messenger of Allah s(g but remained in Makkah and went out with the idolators for the battle of Badr. They were killed among those who were killed. Thus, this honorable Ayah was revealed^2 about those who reside among the idolators, while able to perform Hijrah and unable to practice the faith. Such people will be committing m Fath Al-Bari 8:1 11 AMabari 9 :108

injustice against themselves and falling into a prohibition according to the consensus and also according to this Ayah, ^rrr*^ fas AVerily, as for those whom the angels take (in death) while they are wronging

themselves,) by refraining from Hijrah, i'ft& AThey (angels) say (to them): "In what (condition) were you?") meaning, why did you remain here and not perform Hijrah? AThey reply: "We were weak and oppressed on the earth") meaning, we are unable to leave the land or move about in the earth, Afa& j4 'Jz fH AThey (angels) say: "Was not the earth of Allah spacious enough for you). Abu Dawud recorded that Samurah bin Jundub said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, ^Whoever mingles with the idolator and resides with him, he is just like him. o11 ' Allah's statement, AExcept the weak) until the end of the Ayah, is an excuse that Allah gives for this type of people not to emigrate, because they are unable to free themselves from the idolators. And even if they did, they would not know which way to go. This is why Allah said, Afa tufa.% fa offak -i) AWIw cannot devise a plan, nor are they able to direct their [iT Abu Dawud 3 :224

way), meaning, they do not find the way to emigrate, as Mujahid, Ikrimah and As-Suddi stated . Allah's statement, jMJU 1 iThese are they whom Allah is likely to forgive them,) means, pardon them for not migrating, and here, 'likely' means He shall, iatid Allah is Ever Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving). Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "While the Messenger of Allah was praying Isha ', he said, 'Sami'AUahu Liman Hamidah.' He then said before he prostrated, y. ^ pb' ifLl* y. Lily p-fU' y. ^ 1 jxil pjiJl ^ a«.<?: . oi l jll pjijl y~f p^bl "O Allah! Save 'Ayyash bin Abi Rabfah . O Allah! Save Salamah bin Hishdm. 0 Allah! Save Al-Walfd bin Al-Waltd. O Allah! Save the weak Muslims. 0 Allah! Be very hard on Mudar tribe. O Allah! Afflict them with years (of famine) similar to the (famine) years of the time of Prophet Ymsm/.»"*21 Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu An-Nu'man said that Hammad bin Zayd said that Ayyub narrated that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the verse, iExcept the weak ones among men), "I and my mother were among those (weak ones) whom Allah excused."|31 Allah's statement, 4b; \$r 4 V-&& j j& At-Tabari 9 : 1 1 Al-Bukhari no . 804 131 Fath Al-Bari 8:113

4He who emigrates in the cause of Allah, will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by.} this encourages the believers to perform Hijrah and abandon the idolaters, for wherever the believer emigrates, he will find a safe refuge to resort to. Mujahid said that, 4<ga& imany dwelling places means, he will find a way out of what he dislikes. Allah's statement, iand plenty to live by.} refers to provision. Qatadah also said that, 4...will find on earth many dwelling places and plenty to live by> means, Allah will take him from misguidance to guidance and from poverty to richness. * Allah's statement, \$ J!. && 4And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reward is then surely, incumbent upon Allah. ^ means, whoever starts emigrating and dies on the way, he will acquire the reward of those who emigrate for Allah. The Two Sahihs, along with the Musnad and Sunan compilers, recorded that TJmar bin Al-Khattab said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^1 aj CjIS iC>lcJL JI^pS/I Lwt si^il j\ 1 l di Cols' j*J JU»1 J! 'jlj—JJ ».'ll -'ll 11 III . I «77ie reward of deeds depends upon the intentions, and every person will be rewarded according to what he has intended. So, whoever emigrated to Allah and His Messenger, then his tM At-Tabari 9:121

emigration is for Allah and His Messenger. And whoever emigrated for worldly benefits or for a woman to marry, his emigration is for what he emigrated for. »,1J This Hadith is general, it applies to Hijrah as well as every other deed. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that a man killed ninety-nine people and completed the number one hundred when he killed a worshipper. He then asked a scholar if he has a

chance to repent. The scholar said, “What prevents you from repentance?” The scholar told the killer to emigrate from his land to another land where Allah is worshipped. When he left his land and started on the migration to the other land, death overtook him on the way. The angels of mercy and the angels of torment disputed about the man, whereas the former said that he went out in repentance, while the latter said that he did not arrive at his destination. They were commanded to measure the distance between the two lands and to whichever land he is closer to, he will be considered part of that land. Allah commanded that the righteous land to move closer and the land of evil to move farther. The angels found that he died closer to the land that he intended to emigrate to by a hand-span, and thus the angels of mercy captured his soul. In another narration, when death came to that man, he moved his chest towards the righteous village that he emigrated to.² i:k.<4&# \tfr kgs k rtf 4101. And when you Darabtum in the land, there is no sin on you if you shorten the Salah if you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial, verily, the disbelievers are ever unto you open enemies.} SalatALQasr, Shortening the Prayer Allah said, 4 *fci 111 Fath Al-B&ri 1 :164, Muslim 3 :1515, Abu Dawud 2 :651 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :283, An-Nasaf 7 :713, Ibn Majah 2 :1413, Ahmad 1 :25 121 Fath Al-B&ri 6 :59 1 and Muslim 4:2118

564 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4And when you Darabtum in the land , meaning if you travel in the land. In another Ayah, Allah said, j-lu& 4 °y^i 1 4He knows that there will be some among you sick, others Yadribiina (traveling) through the land, seeking of Allah's bounty...} [73:20]. Allah's statement. Si lx-"" Ji te. ££ f\$} ithere is no sin on you ifyou shorten the Saldh (prayer)} by reducing (the units of the prayer) from four to two. Allah's statement, & <\$ jp& 4if you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial (attack you)}, refers to the typical type of fear prevalent when this Ayah was revealed. In the beginning of Islam, and after the Hijrah, Muslims used to experience fear during most of their travels. Rather, they restricted their movements to large or short military expeditions. During that era, most areas were areas of combatant enemies of Islam and its people. But when the prevalent circumstances cease, or a new situation is prevalent, decrees of this nature may not be understood, as Allah said; 00J 5) .jUi' jc IA/3 fj} }And force not your slave girls to prostitution, if they desire chastity}. And His saying; i'&a« a^ 4And your stepdaughters, under your guardianship, bom of your wives whom you have gone into} Imam Ahmad recorded that Yala bin Umayyah said, “I asked •Umar bin Al-Khattab about the verse: 4fj&3 (fc&i j' pf -j) j. i_ » :r 'Xr-*** J& 'JO- ithere is no sin on you if you shorten the prayer. If you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial,}

‘Allah granted Muslims safety now? “Umar said to me, ‘I wondered about the same thing and asked the Messenger of Allah sg about it and he said, UfJ 41)1 1yiu “A gift that Allah has bestowed on you, so accept His gift».”111 Muslim and the collectors of Sunan recorded this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan SahOi”.121 ‘Ali bin Al-Madlmi said, “This Hadith is Hasan Sahih from the narration of ‘Umar, and it is not preserved by any other route besides this one, and its narrators are all known.” Abu Bakr Ibn Abi Shaybah recorded that Abu Hanzalah Al- Hadha’ said, “I asked Ibn ‘Umar about the Qasr prayer and he said, ‘It consists of two Rak'ahs.’ I said, what about Allah's statement, 4 ' (£4? J ft iif you fear that the disbelievers may put you in trial (attack you),) ‘We are safe now.’ He said, This is the Sunnah of the Ahmad 1 :25 Muslim 1 :478 , Abu Dawud 2 :7 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :392 , An- Nasaf in Al-Kubara 6 : 327 and Ibn Majah 1 :339 4— tjji \ ^\$-1 ^to \Sj iJLsas olSoi(^=Clc. 3 ^If Clot ^^ 1JytAJLI-S ij£J==j a

5jiLiJl s yi- jy_ ^j0liyi j>J*b l\ift ^}*>-/j C« «»-3 jj_> l)i_2i^Jl(iAJI^LJyllSj 1^_SC». Sip^5—
4ill<ihjLc

Messenger of Allah jg.”’ 1 ' Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas said, “We went out with the Messenger of Allah from Al-Madinah to Makkah; he used to pray two Rak'ahs until we went back to Al-Madinah.” When he was asked how long they remained in Makkah, he said, “We remained in Makkah for ten days.”¹²¹ This was recorded by the Group. Imam Ahmad recorded that Harithah bin Wahb Al-Khuza'i said, “I prayed behind the Prophet sg for the Zuhr and 'Asr prayers in Mina, when the people were numerous and very safe, and he prayed two Rak'ahs. ”¹⁴ ' This was recorded by the Group, with the exception of Ibn Majah. 15 ' Al-Bukhari's narration of this Hadith reads, “The Prophet jg led us in the prayer at Mina during the peace period by offering two Rak'ahs.”^ 'i 'jii-tij yiili fju piii IjiiSJ' (tfj ijji-tij viXu ijUii* 2 ijji ollj cn bi*- !->i t -- * < >*(- i' < . S\ > ^i- ^ lyua o' (•—J j' Oo OJ JJ •-'e-'j 4^ S3&4 Us <4102. When you (O Messenger Muhammad jg) are among them, and lead them in Salah, let one party of them stand up [in prayer] with you, taking their arms with them; when they finish their prostrations, let them take their positions in the rear and let the other party come up which have not yet prayed, and let them pray with you, taking all the precautions and bearing arms. Those who disbelieve wish, if you were negligent of your 111 Ibn Abi Shaybah 2 :447 121 Fath Al-Bari 2 :653 131 Muslim 1:481, Abu Dawud 2:25, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:110, An- Nasal 3 :121 and Ibn Majah 1 :342 > Ahmad 4 :306 ' Fath Al-Bari 2:655, Muslim 1 :484, Abu Dawud 2 :493, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 3 :621 and An- Nasal 3 :1 19 161 Fath Al-Bari 2 :655

arms and your baggage, to attack you in a single rush, but there is no sin on you if you put away your arms because of the inconvenience of rain or because you are ill, but take every precaution for yourselves. Verily, Allah has prepared a humiliating torment for the disbelievers.} The Description of The Fear Prayer The Fear prayer has different forms, for the enemy is sometimes in the direction of the Qiblah and sometimes in another direction. The Fear prayer consists sometimes of four Rak'ahs, three Rak'ahs, as for Maghrib, and sometimes two Rak'ah like Fajr and prayer during travel. The Fear prayer is sometimes prayed in congregation, but when the battle is raging, congregational prayer may not be possible. In this case, they pray each by himself, facing the Qiblah or otherwise, riding or on foot. In this situation, they are allowed to walk and fight, all the while performing the acts of the prayer. Some scholars said that in the latter case, they pray only one Rak'ah, for Ibn 'Abbas narrated, “By the words of your Prophet si, Allah has ordained the prayer of four Rak'ah while residing, two Rak'ah during travel, and one Rak'ah during fear.” Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah recorded it. 111 This is also the view of Ahmad bin Hanbal. Al-Mundhiri said, “This is the saying of 'Ata', Jabir, Al-Hasan, Mujahid, Al- Hakam, Qatadah and Hammad; and Tawus and Ad-Dahhak also preferred it.” Abu 'Asim Al-'Abadi mentioned that Muhammad bin Nasr Al-Marwazi said the Fajr prayer also becomes one Rak'ah during fear. This is also the opinion of Ibn Hazm. Ishaq bin Rahwayh said, “When a battle is raging, one Rak'ah during which you nod your head is sufficient for you. If you are unable, then one prostration is sufficient, because the prostration is remembrance of Allah.”

The Reason behind Revealing this Ayah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1263–1292]

Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu 'Ayyash Az-Zuraqi said, "We were with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ in the area of Tjfsan (a 111 Muslim: 687, Abu Dawud: 1247, An-Nasal 3 : 169 and Ibn Majah:

well known place near Makkah), when the idolators met us under the command of Khalid bin Al-Walid, and they were between us and the Qiblah. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ led us in Zuhrah prayer, and the idolators said, 'They were busy with something during which we had a chance to attack them.' They then said, 'Next, there will come a prayer ('Asr) that is dearer to them than their children and themselves.' However, Jibril came down with these Ayat between the prayers of Zuhrah and 'Asr, ji+J o-jti vLJT iWhen you (O Messenger Muhammad ﷺ) are among them, and lead them in Saldh (prayer)}. When the time for prayer came, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ commanded Muslims to hold their weapons and he made us stand in two lines behind him. When he bowed, we all bowed behind him. When he raised his head, we all raised our heads. The Prophet ﷺ then prostrated with the line that was behind him while the rest stood in guard. When they finished with the prostration and stood up, the rest sat and performed prostration, while those who performed it stood up in guard after the two lines exchanged position. The Prophet ﷺ then bowed and they all bowed after him, then raised their heads after he raised his head. Then the Prophet ﷺ performed prostration with the line that was behind him, while the rest stood in guard. When those who made prostration sat, the rest prostrated. The Prophet ﷺ then performed the Taslim and ended the prayer. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ performed this prayer twice, once in Tjfsan and once in the land of Banu Sulaym."111 This is the narration recorded by Abu Dawud and An-Nasa'i, * and it has an authentic chain of narration and many other texts to support it. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Once the Prophet ﷺ led the Fear prayer and the people stood behind him. He said Allahu-Akbar and the people said the same. He bowed and some of them bowed. Then he prostrated and they also prostrated. Then he stood for the second Rak'ah and those who 111 Ahmad 4:59-60 '2| Abu Dawud 2 :28 and An-Nasal 3 :176-177

569 Surah 4. An-Nisr' (Part-5) had prayed the first Rak'ah left and guarded their brothers. The second party joined him and performed bowing and prostration with him. All the people were in prayer, but they were guarding one another during the prayer."111 Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ led them in the Fear prayer. A group of them stood before him and a group behind him. The Prophet ﷺ led those who were behind him with one Rak'ah and two prostrations. They then moved to the position of those who did not pray, while the others stood in their place, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ performed one Rak'ah and two prostrations and then said the Salam. Therefore, the Prophet ﷺ prayed two Rak'ah while they prayed one . An-Nasa'i recorded this Hadith, while Muslim collected other wordings for it. Collectors of the Sahih, Sunan and Musnad collections recorded this in a Hadith from Jabir. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Salim said that his father said, iWhen you (O Messenger Muhammad ﷺ) are among them, and lead them in Saldh (prayer)} refers to the Fear prayer. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ led one group and prayed one Rak'ah, while the second group faced the enemy. Then the second group that faced the enemy came and Allah's Messenger ﷺ led them, praying one Rak'ah, and then said the Salam. Each of the two groups then stood up and prayed one more Rak'ah each (while the other group stood in guard). "•3| The Group collected this Hadith with Ma'mar in its chain of narrators. This Hadith also has many other chains of narration from several Companions, and Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Ibn Marduyah collected these various narrations, as did Ibn Jarir. As for the command to hold the weapons during the Fear prayer, a group of

scholars said that it is obligatory according to the Ayah. What testifies to this is that Allah said; 111 Fath At-Bari 2 :502 ^ Ahmad 3 :298 , An-Nasal 3 : 174 and Muslim : 840 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur2 :375

Iyuiu J jf , ^-Im ^ ^ i>» (^- =C^t- jj_i- ift , > .{ j'-er b^j 4B«f there is no sin on you if you put away your arms because of the inconvenience of rain or because you are ill, but take every precaution for yourselves } meaning, so that when necessary, you will be able to get to your weapons easily, 4^ £3 it l\} 4Verily , Allah has prepared a humiliating torment for the disbelievers}. fc <>& <£* it tj£.SS ;j&f if 58&& v c if •* a.#; ^ ij>s <(103. When you have finished the Salah, remember Allah standing, sitting down, and on your sides, but when you are free from danger, perform the Salah. Verily, Salah is kitdban on the believers atfixed hours.} 4104. And don't be weak in the pursuit of the enemy ; if you are suffering (hardships) then surely they (too) are suffering (hardships) as you are suffering, but you have a hope from Allah (for the reward, i.e. Paradise) that for which they hope not; and Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise.} The Order for Ample Remembrance Alter the Fear Prayer Allah commands Dhikr after finishing the Fear prayer, in particular, even though such Dhikr is encouraged after finishing other types of prayer in general. In the case of Fear prayer, Dhikr is encouraged even more because the pillars of the prayer are diminished since they move about while performing it, etc., unlike other prayers. Allah said about the Sacred Months, 4'^=>-^ tri ^

Stirah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) 571 iso wrong not yourselves therein}, even though injustice is prohibited all year long. However, injustice is particularly outlawed during the Sacred Months due to their sanctity and honor. So Allah's statement, & £& 'it iWhen you have finished Saldh, remember Allah standing, sitting down, and on your sides,} means, in all conditions, t \lj} iBut when you are free from danger perform the Saldh.} when you are safe, tranquil and fear subsides, \£&} iperfortn the Saldh} by performing it as you were commanded; fulfilling its obligations, with humbleness, completing the bowing and prostration positions etc. Allah's statement, iVerily, the Saldh is Kitaban on the believers atfixed hours.} means, enjoined, as Ibn 'Abbas stated.111 Ibn 'Abbas also said, "The prayer has a fixed time, just as the case with Hajj."W Similar is reported from Mujahid, Salim bin 'Abdullah, 'Ali bin Al-Husayn, Muhammad bin 'Ali, Al-Hasan, Muqatil. As-Suddi and 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi.*31 The Encouragement to Pursue the Enemy Despite Injuries Allah's statement, iAnd don't be weak in the pursuit of the enemy;} means, do not weaken your resolve in pursuit of your enemy. At-Tabari 9:169 At-Tabari 9:169 131 At-Tabari 9:167, 168

J asaij® si ?ss»m \$£-»-J'j o \$Q) 2ii\$.Sy*^*\$ />.<Si - <- •" *^<'1 >-'<' •iir-'-li* " tjyj=-4ai li^jlJuki-il* —<^>0*3 t*Jiy»-L_A&au'oKji •& J^z^c&£Z'Z£&\$££ Rather, pursue them vigorously, fight them and be wary of them. oj-& i>/2 oi^ iff you are suffering then surely they are suf- fering as you are suffering,} meaning, just as you suffer from injuries and death, the same happens to the enemy. In another Ayah, Allah said, i' *'.' -W.i .{ '•" iV U" * ^ ^ 4 iA~i jy-> iff you suffer a harm, be sure a similar harm Itas struck the others}. Allah then said, V -i' Ss ibut you have a hope from Allah that for which they hope not;} meaning, you and they are equal regarding the injuries and pain that you suffer from. However, you hope for Allah's reward, victory and aid, just as He has promised you in His Book and by the words of his Messenger j|s. Surely, Allah's promise is true. On the other hand, your enemies do not have hope for any of this. So, it is you, not they, who should be eager to fight so that you establish the Word of Allah and raise it high. CLi? iif

Sitralt 4. An-Nisa (Part-5) 573 iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise. means, He is most knowledgeable and wise in all what He decides, decrees, wills and acts on concerning various worldly and religious ordainments, and He is worthy of praise in all conditions. Js •£ iif \ iui \) Cfjff JC- SS" iit 'Ji o-iSif Si sAiEJi 'v.Q 65. sf ^ 44 "?" & Si^ SM fV " \ ' *,1 Vifi /.*' o / < K s> * >" '> * -*> ' oy -^M u_» auj jbj Jyu' ^ ^ 4*- * aii1 j » ^ ^ . .x*' If • »>?/ r<> ^ . *. > •>j£ pr^ cr*- * LwjJ' ^ ej >\ 1 U.^ in;^ "o£k J* f' +7±jl\ 4105. Surely, We have sent down to you (0 Mulmnmad 0) the Book in truth tluit you might judge between men by that which Allah has shown you, so be not a pleader for the treacherous.4 4106. And seek the forgiveness of Allah, certainly, Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 4107. And argue not on behalf of those who deceive themselves. Verily, Allah does not like anyone who is a betrayer, sinner. 4108. They may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them) from Allah; for He is with them (by His knowledge), when they plot by night in words that He does not approve. And Allah ever encompasses what they do.) 4109. Lo! You are those who have argued for them in the life of this world, but who will argue for them on the Day of Resurrection against Allah, or who will then be their defender?) The Necessity of Referring to What Allah has Revealed forJudgement Allah says to His Messenger, Muhammad jg, 4&S\ CZE\\$ \ %) 4Surely, We have sent down to you the Book in truth) meaning, it truly came from Allah and its narrations and

p p J>JI £i~y tU_ :iU IpiU Ulii jl Ul U£L “Since you said that, then go and divide the inheritance, and try to be just in your division. Then draw lots, and each one of you should forgive his brother thereafter (regardless ofwho got the best share).*” 111 Allah’s statement, it*’ St 'Ji io* .A) 4They may hide (their crimes) from men, but they cannot hide (them) from Allah;} chastises the hypocrites because they hide their evil works from the people so that they will not criticize them. Yet, the hypocrites disclose this evil with Allah, Who has perfect watch over their secrets and knows what is in their hearts. This is why Allah said, tL. jKj Jji)l (ja N/ £ SjpU jl pjii f>)} ifor He is with than (by His knowledge), when they plot by night in words that He does not approve. And Allah ever encompasses what they do} threatening and warning them. Allah then said, 4^j3' pit iiiii £fe>} }Lo! You are those who have argued for than in the life of this world,} meaning, suppose these people gain the verdict from the rulers in their favor in this life, since the rulers judge according to what is apparent to them. However, what will their condition be on the Day of Resurrection before Allah, Who knows the secret and what is even more hidden? Who will be his advocate on that Day? Verily, none will support them that Day. Hence, Allah’s statement, }or who will then be their defender?} m Ahmad 6 :320

by-* -JA 3»j a^ju ^UL 3^ j4,) ^ j! a£lk>» -£j A* l^U jfcj t^_ju ^ a. ,JsJ LM >>'• SS < a * < ' {,. fc• , y > .• <"" •{ *i< »/_•" « /» -C5-JJ tiJub ail' J-^a* Jj)j -;WJUJ5* J»ai sj UJ •^1 i+ Uj ^ i>\ ^ ^jjXiu lij jSjuaj >(4 iijAt c~LJ> J&. ^ <£i6 JSLS J2 , \$ IS dH^S 53% 0£it & j>ij 4""i\dl_k 4210. A/irf whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 111. And whoever earns sin, he earns it only against himself. And Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 4112. And ivhoeever earns a fault or a sin and then blatnes it on someone innocent, he has indeed burdened himself with falsehood and a manifest sin.} 4113. Had not the grace of Allah and His mercy been upon you, a party of them would certainly have made a decision to mislead you, but they mislead none except their own selves, and no harm can they do to you in the least. Allah has sent down to you the Book, and the Hikmah, and taught you that which you knew not. And ever great is the grace ofAllah unto you.} The Encouragement to Seek Allah’s Forgiveness, and Warning thosewho

Falsely Accuse Innocent People Allah emphasizes His generosity and kindness, in that He forgives whoever repents to Him from whatever evil they commit. Allah said, *l i tfA < ^ f L_»-j <m' j a—u pill ji j^»> j*j} } And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.* } ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented about this Ayah, “Allah informs His servants of His forgiveness, forbearing generosity and expansive mercy. So whoever commits a sin, whether minor or major,

*J s * /> < \U. by 1-1 «#'* ibut afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful . even if his sins were greater than the heavens, the earth and the mountains.” Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali said, “Whenever I hear anything from the Messenger of Allah, Allah benefits me with whatever He wills of that. Abu Bakr told me, and Abu Bakr has said the truth, that the Messenger of Allah *jg* said, *jiil (ill-LJ j j*j 4 Lii Ju plzS V& » «aJ 'ii. Vi* “No Muslim commits a sin and then performs ablution, prays two Rak'ahs and begs Allah for forgiveness for that sin, but He forgives him . » He then recited these two Ayat, *4/— 3* '*>- 5*3^ \$Atid* whoever does evil or wrongs himself, and, **^ fii i* And those who, when they have committed Fahishah or wronged themselves with *m7\$>.”* 2 Allah’s statement, *O£ tlil 4LJC; ^3>* whoever earns sin, he earns it only against himself. is similar to His statement, *4<syJ -uj »jjb* no bearer of burdens shall bear the burden of another. So no one will avail anyone else. Rather, every soul, and none else, shall carry its own burden. This is why Allah said, *l« ;*• <5)1 At-Jabari 9:195 * Ahmad 1 :8*

\v mmmam iy}ll|p ' ,.Ur, 1 4-ij) ijty^i aii^i^)[^ol/ ^ c[jxS*>\ %gCj OiC-J dj—waiJ ^LJiJCa_ ^i_jo 4j^ di^jl. ' _ .<* »* f"v- < *- »i< - / • r> s s\xs?' --t (jujo^UjJ^jmaauI sCj3 ul.J'-^l.V J*. Ajjj ^ ^ IjLy ^Ls<j>/ u1^3-ili&Zoi "' **'•*' LLSjj^pL-L-iJ fj_»« {jb ^A-j<(^£-b_)jJ.y (ii2)jl* until the end of the Surah. Allah said, *4And Allah is Ever All- Knowing, All-Wise.* } meaning, this occurs due to His knowledge, wisdom, fairness and mercy. *^2 ^ c ilx&.j} 4and* taught you that which you knew not.}, before this revelation was sent down to you. Similarly, Allah said, *j. 'Ljj JBi uXi SlliQ} 433' & sji3 C \J 4And* thus We have sent to you (O Muham- mad sg) a Rult (a revelation, and a mercy) of Our command. You *kteio* not what is the Book } *4Stu jt VI 3#ji dX)\ yfc &]5£?3 Cj} 4And* you *xoere* not expecting that the Book (this Qur'an) would be sent down to you, but it is a mercy from your Lord}. So Allah said; *4tLJi& .»& Jtj •r^L&'i} 4And* ever great is the grace of Allah unto you (O Multammad #5)K

^ Cj'A.-j /j •»- 4114. There is no good in most of their secret talks save (in) him who orders Sadaqah, or goodness, or conciliation between mankind; and he who does this, seeking the good pleasure of Allah, We shall give him a great reward. 4115. And whoever contradicts and opposes the Messenger after the right path has been shown clearly to him, and follows other than the believers' way, We shall keep him in the path he has chosen, and bum him in Hell - what an evil destination!} Righteous Najwd, Secret Talk Allah said, *cA 4 JA- 4There* is no good in most of their secret talks} meaning, what the people say to each other. *Vo* - • (£— 4save* him who orders Sadaqah (charity), or goodness, or reconciliation between mankind;} meaning, except for this type of talk. Imam Ahmad recorded that Umm Kulthum bint TJqbah said that she heard the Messenger of Allah *jg* saying, “He who brings about reconciliation between people by embellishing good or saying good things, is not a liar. » She also said, “I never heard him allow what the people say (lies) except in three cases: in war, bringing peace between people and the man’s speech (invented compliments) to his wife and her speech to her husband.” Umm Kulthum

bint 'Uqbah was among the immigrant women who gave their pledge of allegiance to the Messenger of Allah jg. 111 The Group also recorded this Hadith, with the exception of Ibn Majah. 121 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Ad-Darda' said that the Ahmad 6 :403 Fath Al-Bari 5 :353 , Muslim 4 :201 1 , Abu Dawud 5 :218 , Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 6 :70 and An-NasaT in Al-Kubra 5 :193

580 Tafsir ton Kathir Messenger of Allah said, l a 1^ ipL-kil i>-jS^ jJiiL Yin «Should I tell you what is better than the grade of fasting, praying and Sadaqah?» They said, “Yes, O Allah’s Messenger!” He said, «jdl oli «Bringing reconciliation between people .» He also said, ^ oli «Spoiling the relationship (between people) is the destroyer.» Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi also recorded this Hadlth}^ and At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih”. Allah said, i\jcJ Jjtiu J*)}} iand he who does this, seeking the good pleasure ofAllah,} with sincerity and awaiting the reward with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, SfZ*} 4We shall give him a great reward. meaning, an immense, enormous and tremendous reward. The Punishment for Contradicting and Opposing the Messenger and Followinga Path Other than That ofthe Believers Allah’s statement, itjtft 3 *2 &} 4And whoever contradicts and opposes the Messenger after the right path has been shown clearly to him.} refers to whoever intentionally takes a path other than the path of the Law revealed to the Messenger, after the truth has l1 ' Ahmad 6:444, Abu Dawud no. 4919 and At-Tirmidhi 2509.

been made clear, apparent and plain to him. Allah’s statement, iand follows other than the believers' way,} refers to a type of conduct that is closely related to contradicting the Messenger j». This contradiction could be in the form of contradicting a text (from the Qur’an or Sunnah) or contradicting what the Ummah of Muhammad jg has agreed on. The U m m a h of Muhammad jgg is immune from error when they all agree on something, a miracle that serves to increase their honor, due to the greatness of their Prophet. There are many authentic Hadtths on this subject. Allah warned against the evil of contradicting the Prophet jg and his Ummah, when He said, rmm &sm \ otY&iis 'j'j-==> i>*J fj| p ""if-' ft t s »(•< . ,/ UdJ^) _& Juc\j iij 4ji\JS j^ Uaurf k If. 3' i^LuJuLaj ll.'.aU) OiU.j jyl j j_y ll 4VVe shall keep him in the path he has chosen, and bum him in Hell - what an evil destination!} meaning, when one goes on this wicked path, We will punish him by making the evil path appear good in his heart, and will beautify it for him so that he is tempted further. For instance, Allah said. t •' •» ** ** .< / * \ Oj v_jjS2

583Surah 4. An-Nisd' (Part-5) 4117. They invoke nothing but female deities besides Him (Allah), and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel!} 4118. Allah cursed him. And he [Shaytan] said: "I will take an appointed portion ofyour servants."} 4119. "Verily, I will mislead them, and surely, I will arouse in them false desires; and certainly, I will order them to slit the ears of cattle, and indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah." And whoever takes Shaytan as a Wali instead ofAllah, has surely suffered a manifest loss.} 4120. He [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} 4121. The dwelling ofsuch (people) is Hell, and they will find no way ofescapefrom it.} 4122. And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, We shall admit them to the Gardens under which rivers flcno (i.e. in Paradise) to dioell therein forever. Allah's promise is the truth; and whose words can be truer than those ofAllah?} Shirk Shall not be Forgiven, in Reality the Idolators Worship Shaytan We talked about Allah’s statement, 4Verily, Allah forgives not (the sin of) setting up partners (in toorship) with Him, but He

forgives whom He wills, sins other than that,} before and mentioned the relevant Hadiths in the beginning of this Surah.. Allah's statement, 4'ju^I vii jji -it £)} 4and whoever sets up partners in worship xvith Allah, has indeed strayedfar away.} means, he will have taken otherthan the true path, deviated from guidance and righteousness, destroyed himselfin this lifeand the Hereafter,and lostcontentment in this lifeand the Hereafter. Juwaybir said that Ad-Dahhak said about Allah's statement,

4&{ V Jt AThey invoke nothing butfemale deities besides Him (Allah), "The idolators claimed that the angels are Allah's daughters , saying, *We only worship them so that they bring us closer to Allah.' So they took the angels as gods, made the shapes of girls and decided, These (idols) resemble the daughters of Allah (i.e., the angels), Whom we worship.'" This is similar to Allah's statements, 4;§;*>\$ cJ AHave you theti considered Al-Lat and Al-'Uzzd>*2' i^~j} AAnd they make the angels who themselves are servants of the Most Gracious (Allah) females and, AAnd they have invented a kinship between Him and the Jinn}. Allah's statement, Aand they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel!} means, Shaytan has commanded them to do this and made it seem fair and beautiful in their eyes. Consequently, they are worshipping Shaytan in reality, just as Allah said in another Ayah, ADid I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan} Allah said that, on the Day of Resurrection, the angels shall proclaim about the idolators who worshipped them in this life: A'> 'A rn f .. ^ AHay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most of them were 111 At-Jabari 9 :209 ' Two ofthe most popular idols during that time

585Surah 4. An-Nisa' (Part-5) believers in them}. Allah's statement, ZJ} iAlldh cursed him}, means, He expelled him and banished him from His mercy and His grace. 4/ will take an appointed portion ofyour servants} means, a fixed and known share. Muqatil bin Hayyan commented, "From every one thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will go to the Fire and one to Paradise." }Verily, 1 will mislead them} from the true path, iand surely, 1 will arouse in them false desires;} tempting them to feign repentance, arousing false hopes in them, encouraging them to delay and procrastinate with righteous deeds, deceiving them. iand certainly, I will order them to slit the ears of cattle,} meaning, slitting their ears to designate them as Bahirah, 1^ Sa'ibah,*21 and a Wasilah,^ ' as Qatadah and As-Suddi stated. iAnd indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah.} A camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it A camel let loose for free pasture for their idols and nothing was allowed to be carried on it. 131 A camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a female camel at its first delivery, and then again gives birth to a female camel at its second delivery 141 At-Tabari 9:214

means tattooing, according to Al-Hasan bin Abi Al-Hasan Al- Basri. In his Sahth, Muslim recorded the prohibition of tattooing the face, which in one of its wordings states: "May Allah curse whoever does this."111 It is also recorded in the Sahih that Ibn Mas*ud said, "May Allah curse those who have tattoos and those who do it, who pluck their (facial) hairs and the one who does it for them, and those who make spaces between their teeth for the purpose of beauty, changing what Allah has created." He then said, "Why should not I curse whom the Messenger of Allah jg has cursed, when the Book of Allah commands it," referring to the Ayah, ilc 'Cj Zj} iAnd whatsoever the Messenger gives you, take it; and ivhatsoever heforbids you, abstain (from Allah's statement, iAnd whoever takes Shaytan as a Wali

(protector or helper) instead of Allah, has surely suffered a manifest loss means, he will have lost this life and the Hereafter. Indeed, this is a type of loss that cannot be compensated or restored. Allah's statement, > » iHe [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires explains the true reality. Surely, Shaytan deceitfully promises his supporters and tempts them into believing that they are winners in this and the Hereafter. This is why Allah said, and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.> Allah states that on the Day of Return, ^ ^ Muslim 3:1618, Fath Al-Bari 10:392, and the tattooing cursed is not restricted to the face, as it appears Ibn Kathir intended. Fath Al-Bari 8:498

Cj gsz, jMJ dSi >Vf^ -44i; 4And Shaytan zoill say when the matter has been decided: "Verily , Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you), until, 4%)}} i'i*\$ S/Aiti j[] 4Verily , there is a painful torment for the wrongdoers. Allah's statement, 4of such (people)) refers to those who like and prefer what Shaytan is promising and assuring them of. 4The dwelling of such (people) is Hell}, as their destination and abode on the Day of Resurrection, 4U4& 5/4 4and they will find no way of escape from it .), meaning, they will not be able to avoid, avert, evade or elude the Hellfire. The Reward of Righteous Believers Allah then mentions the condition of the content righteous believers and the perfect honor they will earn in the end. Allah said, Ir*' 4And those ivho believe and do righteous good deeds,) meaning, their hearts were truthful and their limbs obedient with the righteous acts they were commanded, all the while abandoning the evil they were prohibited from doing. 0; y-Jf -y 4Ne shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise)) meaning, they will think of where they want these rivers to

flow and they will flow there, 4to dwell therein forever}, without end or being removed from it. tr 4 jOli iTf} {Allah s promise is the truth}, meaning, this is a true promise from Allah, and verily, Allah's promise shall come to pass. Allah then said, k <Si oil £2^ {and whose ivords can be truer than those ofAllah?} meaning, none is more truthful in statement and narration than Allah. There is no deity worthy of worship, or Lord except Him. The Messenger of Allah jg used to proclaim in his speech, jZ.j ,4_uAJ I JjLii jl» "The most truthful speech is Allah's Speech, and the best guidance is the guidance of Muhammad. The worst matters are the newly invented (in religion), every neioly invented matter is an innovation, and every innovation is a heresy, and every heresy is in the Firej Mi* yj ck \$ Ce jLL . • rM , 'n 'jwii LJj *a> o/i k h4-j (ill £1; {^} jij •,«;< '* £££ % iliji ytjj^ O'jU-JI j L> >— li? jjifj U-j- ilj j-Jj £_j>: 4123. /f will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, and he will not find any protector or helper besides Allah .} {124. And whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a believer, such will enter Paradise and not the least injustice, even to the size of a Naqir, will be done to them.} {125. And who can be better in religion than one who submits

hisface (himself) to Allah; and he is a Muhsin (a doer of good). And follows the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist). And Allah did take Ibrahim as a Khalil (an intimate friend)!} 4126. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is Ever Encompassing all things .} Success is Only Achieved by Performing Righteous Deeds, not Wishful Thinking Qatadah said, "We were told that the Muslims and the People of the Scriptures mentioned their own virtues to each other. People of the Scriptures said, 'Our Prophet came before your Prophet and our Book before your Book. Therefore, we should have more right to Allah than you have.' Muslims said, "Rather, we

have more right to Allah than you, our Prophet is the Final Prophet and our Book supersedes all the Books before it.' Allah sent down, it will not be in accordance with your desires (Muslims), nor those of the People of the Scripture (Jews and Christians), whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof}, A A*-' iU Ai 2A@-* ief} 4And who can be better in religion than one who submits his face (himself) to Allah; and he is a Muhsin.} Allah then supported the argument of the Muslims against their opponents of the other religions." Similar statements were attributed to As-Suddi, Masruq, Ad-Dahhak and Abu Salih.*2 * Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah [4:123], "The followers of various religions disputed, the people of the Tawrah said, 'Our Book is the best Book and our Prophet (Musa) is the best Prophet.' The people of the Injil said similarly, the people of Islam said, There is no religion except Islam, our Book has abrogated every other Book, our Prophet is the Final Prophet, and you were commanded to believe in 111 At-Tabari 9 :229 * At-Tabari 9:229-231

590 Tafcir Ibn Kathir your Books and adhere to our Book.' Allah judged between them, saying. j*. '*>- it will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof} .",1) This Ayah indicates that the religion is not accepted on account of wishful thinking or mere hopes. Rather, the accepted religion relies on what resides in the heart and which is made truthful through actions. It is not true that when one utters a claim to something, he attains it merely on account of his claim. It is not true that every person who claims to be on the truth is considered as such, merely on account of his words, until his claim gains merit with proof from Allah. Hence Allah's statement, '*> it will not be in accordance with your desires, nor those of the People of the Scripture, whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof}, meaning safety will not be acquired by you or them just by wishful thinking. Rather, the key is in obeying Allah and following what He has legislated through the words of His honorable Messengers. This is why Allah said afterwards, iwhosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof, > Similarly, Allah said, »J> A JI_M v tjA fc*- jUu J^j} iSo whosoever does good equal to the weight of an atom, shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of an atom, shall see it.} and it was reported that when these Ayat were revealed, they became hard on many Companions. HI At-Tabari 9 :230

Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'A'ishah said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah! I know the hardest Ayah in the Qur'an.' He said, What is it, O 'A'ishah!' 1 said, i-HA *2SZ^ ^whoever works evil, iwill have the recompense thereof,} He said, Z&\ Jj. JuJl L-J.. U <tThat is what strikes the believing servant, even the problems that bother him. a"" * Ibn Jarir and Abu Dawud¹² ' also recorded this Hadith. Said bin Mansur recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "When the Ayah, 4*^ '»jr> iwhosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof,} was revealed, it was hard on Muslims. The Messenger of Allah said to them, zf3\j <tBe steadfast and seek closeness. Everything that afflicts the Muslim, even the thorn that pierces his skin and the hardship he suffers, will be an expiation for him. *""*³¹ This is the wording collected by Ahmad through Sufyan bin 'Uyaynah.*4 ' Muslim 151 and At-Tirmidhi⁶ also recorded it. Allah's statement, jJJ Ji \$ j-f. iand he will not find any protector or helper besides Allah,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said; "Unless he At-Tabari 9 :244 ' At-Tabari 9 :246 and Abu Dawud 3 :471 ' Said bin MansQr 4:1378 141 Ahmad 2 :248 151 Muslim 4 :1993 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :400 and An-Nasal in AlKubra 6 :328

repents and Allah forgives him.” Ibn Abi Hatim recorded it. Allah then said, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {And whoever does righteous good deeds, male or female, and is a believer}. Allah mentions the recompense for evil actions and that He will surely inflict its punishment on the servant, either in this life, which is better for him, or in the Hereafter, we seek refuge with Allah from this end. We also beg Allah for our well-being in this life and the Hereafter and for His forgiveness, mercy and pardon. Allah then mentions His kindness, generosity and mercy in accepting the good deeds from His servants, whether male or female, with the condition that they embrace the faith. He also stated that He will admit the believers into Paradise and will not withhold any of their righteous deeds, even the weight of a Naqir - speck on the back of a date-stone. Earlier, we discussed the FatH - the scaly thread in the long slit of a date-stone, and both of these, along with the Qitmir - the thin membrane over the date-stone were mentioned in the Qur’an. Allah then said, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {And who can be better in religion than one who submits his face to Allah.} meaning, performs the good actions in sincerity for his Lord with faith and awaiting the reward with Allah, and he is a Muhsin} following the correct guidance that Allah legislated in the religion of truth which He sent His Messenger with. These are the two conditions, in the absence of which no deed will be accepted from anyone; sincerity and correctness. The work is sincere when it is performed for Allah alone and it becomes correct when it conforms to the Shar’ah. So, the m At-Tabari 9 :239

deed becomes outwardly correct with following the Sunnah and inwardly correct with sincerity. When any deed lacks either of these two conditions, the deed becomes null and void. For instance, when one lacks the pillar of sincerity in his work, he becomes a hypocrite who shows off for people. Whoever does not follow the Shari’ah, he becomes an ignorant, wicked person. When one combines both pillars, his actions will be the deeds of the faithful believers whose best deeds are accepted from them and their errors erased. Consequently, Allah said, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {And follows the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist).} referring to Muhammad and his following, until the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {Verily, among mankind who have the best claim to Ibrahim are those who followed him, and this Prophet}, and, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {Then, We have sent the Revelation to you (saying): "Follow the religion of Ibrahim the Hanif (Monotheist) and he was not of the Mushrikin}. The Hanif, intentionally and with knowledge, avoids Shirk, he goes attentively to the truth, allowing no one to hinder him or stop him from it. Ibrahim is Allah’s Khalil Allah’s statement, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {And Allah did take Ibrahim as a Khalil (an intimate friend)!} encourages following Ibrahim Al-Khalil, because he was and still is an Imam whose conduct is followed and imitated. Indeed, Ibrahim reached the ultimate closeness to Allah that the servants seek, for he attained the grade of Khalil, which is the highest grade of love. He acquired all this due to his obedience to His Lord, just as Allah has described him,

Leftist {And of Ibrahim, the one who fulfilled}, {And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim tried him with (certain) commands, which he fulfilled}, and, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {Verily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, obedient to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the Mushrikin}. Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Amr bin Maymun said that when Mu’adh came back from Yemen, he led them in the Fajr prayer and recited, *وَمَنْ يَفْعَلْ ذَلِكَ يَنْتَظِرْ لِقَاءِ رَبِّهِ* {And Allah did take Ibrahim as a Khalil!} One of the men present commented, “Surely, the eye of Ibrahim’s mother has been comforted.”* 11 Ibrahim was called Allah’s Khalil due to his Lord’s great love towards him, on account of the acts of obedience he performed that Allah loves and prefers. We should mention here that in the Two Sahls, it is recorded that Abu Sa’id Al-Khudri said that when the

Messenger of Allah ﷺ gave them his last speech, he said, *«O people! If I were to take a Khalil from the people of the earth, I would have taken Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhdjhah as my Khalil. However, your companion (meaning himself) is the Khalil of Allah. a*2 Jundub bin ‘Abdullah Al-Bajali, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin Al-‘As and ‘Abdullah bin Mas‘ud narrated that the Prophet ﷺ said, >\ US’ i OJ [1 * Path Al-Bari 7 :662 121 Fath Al-Bari 7:15; Muslim 4 : 1854*

Allah has chosen me as His Khalil, just as He has chosen Ibrahim as His Khalil. n' 11 Allah's statement, 4 4 4 U 4-A/id to AZ/a/i belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earthy means, everything and everyone are His property, servants and creation, and He has full authority over all of this. There is no one who can avert Allah's decision or question His judgment. He is never asked about what He does due to His might, ability, fairness, wisdom, compassion and mercy. Allah's statement, ill iAnd Allah is Ever Encompassing all things.} means, His knowledge encompasses everything and nothing concerning His servants is ever hidden from Him. Nothing, even the weight of an atom, ever escapes His observation in the heavens and earth, nor anything smaller or bigger than that. xr?- 1 * jU jf- ^ Uj idaJ , ,h 4227. They ask your legal instruction concerning women. Say "Allah instructs you about them, and about what is recited unto you in the Book concerning the orphan girls whom you give not ivhat tltey deserve and yet whom you desire to marry, and the children who are iveak and oppressed, and that you stand firm for justice to orfihans. And whatever good you do, Allah is Ever All-Aware of it The Ruling Concerning Female Orphans Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah said about the Ayah, Muslim 1 : 377 and 4:1855, Ibn Majah 1 :50, Muslim 4:1855

ill Ji 4 i&fjelij} iThey ask your instruction concerning women. Say, "Allah instructs you about them...} until, ol&h} iwhom you desire to marry...} “It is about the man who is taking care of a female orphan, being her caretaker and inheritor. Her money is joined with his money to such an extent, that she shares with him even the branch of a date that he has. So he likes (for material gain) to marry her himself, and hates to marry her to another man who would have a share in his money, on account of her share in his money. Therefore, he refuses to let her marry anyone else. So, this Ayah was revealed. ”I 11 Muslim also recorded it. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “The people asked Allah’s Messenger (about orphan girls), so Allah revealed, 4 (^=4* Cj Sis* 4 iThey ask your instruction concerning women. Say, "Allah instructs you about them and about what is recited unto you in the Book..." ^

What is meant by Allah’s saying, ‘And about what is recited

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1292–1300]

unto you in the Book’ is the former verse which said, ilf you fear that you shall not be able to deal justly with the orphan girls, then marry (other) women ofyour choice.}^ ‘A’ishah said, "Allah’s statement, iwhom you desire to marry...} also refers to the desire of the guardian not to marry an orphan girl under his supervision when she lacks property or beauty. The guardians were FathAl-Bari 8:1 14 121 Muslim 4:1423 At-Tabari 9 :258

597Surah 4. An-Nisa (Part-5) forbidden to marry their orphan girls possessing property and beauty without being just to them, as they generally refrain from marrying them (when they are neither beautiful nor wealthy). ”• 11 The basis of this is recorded in Two Sahihs. Consequently, when a man is

the caretaker of a female orphan, he might like to marry her himself. In this case, Allah commands him to give her a suitable dowry that other women of her status get. If he does not want to do that, then let him marry other women, for Allah has made this matter easy for Muslims. Sometimes, the caretaker does not desire to marry the orphan under his care, because she is not attractive to his eye. In this case, Allah forbids the caretaker from preventing the female orphan from marrying another man for fear that her husband would share in the money that is mutually shared between the caretaker and the girl. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “During the time of Jahiliyyah, the caretaker of a female orphan would cover her with his rope, and when he did that, no man would marry her. If she was beautiful and he desired to marry her, he married her and took control of her wealth. If she was not beautiful, he did not allow her to marry until she died, and when she died he inherited her money. Allah prohibited and outlawed this practice.”² He also said about Allah’s statement, and the children who are weak and oppressed that during the time of Jahiliyyah, they used to deny young children and females a share of inheritance. So Allah’s statement, you give not what they deserve thus prohibiting this practice and designating a fixed share for each, Fath Al-Bari 9 :6 and Muslim 4:2313 At-Tabari 9 : 264

598 Tafstr Ibn Kathir > ' j3^ C-i »V»t , o^j ^ait^J? <£wt 4^& fk> 4To the male, a portion equal to that of two females..} whether they were young or old, as Said bin Jubayr and others stated. Said bin Jubayr said about Allah’s statement, and that you stand firm for justice to orphans.} “Just as when she is beautiful and wealthy you would want to marry her and have her for yourself, so when she is not wealthy or beautiful, marry her and have her for yourself.”² Allah’s statement, 4If Aft t)ji -A*- Oi 4And whatever good you do, Allah is Ever All-Aware of it.} encourages performing the good deeds and fulfilling the commandments, and states that Allah is knowledgeable of all of this and He will reward for it in the best and most perfect manner. ifJLa tlfu jaj.ni ol If 5r. Vi jt 'jjii t+U) calf- 0!j^ Hj ii' ijiLj) iy- fw! "jp- ait I y*L*aio^J JC3 jtp| ^i.6^ aittjSjt^ , j 0 o^litjU aitj^aSj 1 oy<w.fJ aJJj JC^ajLaJilt^j' |vrt| V^audi^aaitolSj »j>r^ tjLjjit4>lyait 111 At-Tabari 9 :255 121 At-Tabari 9 :255

* ' ill iyJ—jj jrj IjkjjjSi ^ *i'i £*•; ofj :&z. & iSf «ssr OJj 4228. And if a woman fears cruelty or desertion on her husband's part, there is no sin on them both if they make terms of peace between themselves; and making peace is better. And human souls are swayed by greed. But if you do good and have Taqwd, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do.} 4229. You will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire, so do not incline too much to one of them so as to leave the other hanging. And if you do justice, and do all that is right and have Taqwd, then Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4230. But if they separate (by divorce), Allah will provide abundance for everyone of them from His bounty. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All-Wise.} The Ruling Concerning Desertion on the Part of the Husband Allah states, and thus legislates accordingly, that sometimes, the man inclines away from his wife, sometimes towards her and sometimes he parts with her. In the first case, when the wife fears that her husband is steering away from her or deserting her, she is allowed to forfeit all or part of her rights, such as provisions, clothing, dwelling, and so forth, and the husband is allowed to accept such concessions from her. Hence, there is no harm if she offers such concessions, and if her husband accepts them. This is why Allah said, 4‘Eii I^ir 64^4 J Zjji yi} there is no sin on them both if they make terms of peace between themselves;} He then said, 4% iattd making peace is better than divorce. Allah’s statement,

600 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir j3&Vf 4A;id human souls are swayed by greed .} means, coming to peaceful terms, even when it involves forfeiting some rights, is better than parting. Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Sawdah feared that the Messenger of Allah jg might divorce her and she said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Do not divorce me; give my day to ‘A’ishah.’ And he did, and later on Allah sent down, f *4^? Ji ‘If 0l>} \$And if a woman fears cruelty or desertion on her husband's part, there is no sin on them both} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Whatever (legal agreement) the spouses mutually agree to is allowed. ”.11 ' At-Tirmidhi recorded it and said, “Hasan Ghanb”.’2’ In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that ‘A’ishah said that when Sawdah bint Zam'ah became old, she forfeited her day to ‘A’ishah, and the Prophet ^ used to spend Sawdah’s night with ‘A’ishah.’3 ’ There is a similar narration also collected by Al-Bukhari.’4 ’ Al-Bukhari also recorded that ‘A’ishah commented; f '-U" irt off} iAnd if a woman fears cruelty or desertion on her husband's part}, that it refers to, “A man who is married to an old woman, and he does not desire her and wants to divorce her. So she says, *1 forfeit my right on you.’ So this Ayah was revealed.”15’ Meaning of“MakingPeace is Better” Allah said, Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi : 349 ’2 ’ Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :403 ’3 ’ FathAl-Bari 9 :223 and Muslim 2 :1085 ’4| Fath Al-Bari 5 :257 151 Al-Bukhari: 4601

Surah 4, An-Nisa' (Part-5) 601 4And making peace is better}. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah refers to, “When the husband gives his wife the choice between staying with him or leaving him, as this is better than the husband preferring other wives to her.”11 ' However, the apparent wording of the Ayah refers to the settlement where the wife forfeits some of the rights she has over her husband, with the husband agreeing to this concession, and that this settlement is better than divorce. For instance, the Prophet jfe kept Sawdah bint Zam'ah as his wife after she offered to forfeit her day for ‘A’ishah. By keeping her among his wives, his Ummah may follow this kind of settlement. Since settlement and peace are better with Allah than parting, Allah said, iand making peace is better}. Divorce is not preferred with Allah. The meaning ofAllah’s statement, iBut if you do good and have Taqioa, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do} if you are patient with the wife you dislike and treat her as other wives are treated, then Allah knows what you do and will reward you for it perfectly. Allah’s statement, 4 o'*. ^Yok will never be able to do perfect justice between wives even if it is your ardent desire,} means, O people! You will never be able to be perfectly just between wives in every respect. Even when one divides the nights justly between wives, there will still be various degrees concerning love, desire and sexual intimacy, as Ibn ‘Abbas, *Ubaydah As-Salmani, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Ad- Dahhak bin Muzahim stated.’2 ’ Imam Ahmad and the collectors of the Sunan recorded that At-Tabari 9 :272 At-Tabari 9 :285-287

you have power over, while fearing Allah in all conditions, then Allah will forgive you the favoritism that you showed to some ofyour wives. Allah then said, 4 ’ j u_.'j ii' jSj .ajJu. j. iBut if they separate (divorce), Allah will provide abundance for everyone of them from His bounty. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficientfor His creatures' needs, All-Wise. } This is the third case between husband and wife, in which divorce occurs. Allah states that if the spouses separate by divorce, then Allah will suffice them by giving him a better wife and her a better husband. The meaning of, U—'j ii' J&j} 4And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Wise.} is: His favor is tremendous, His bounty is enormous and He is All-Wise in all His actions, decisions and commandments. It v2?)' iyj jiJj ,jyV' 4 4 iuf 0^5 4 Cj j U *3) IjyS2 \$ IS oi it 4 4 c ij -V-t X"1/4* otj jlllli -ft \$*51^5 Cj1> 4,>5 to Allah belongs all that is

in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And verily, We have recommended to the People of the Scripture before you, and to you that you have Taqwa of Allah. But if you disbelieve, then unto Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and Allah is Ever Rich (free of any needs), Worthy of all praise.} 4232. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as Disposer of affairs 4233. If He wills. He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever All-Potent over that.} 4234. Whoever desires the rewards of this life, then with Allah is the reward of this worldly life and of the Hereafter. And

Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Necessity of Taqwa of Allah Allah states that He is the Owner of the heavens and earth and that He is the Supreme Authority over them. Hence Allah's statement, if you disbelieve, then unto Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth.} meaning, We have recommended to you what We recommended to the People of Scriptures; Taqwa of Allah, by worshipping Him Alone without partners. Allah then said, But if you disbelieve, then unto Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth.} In another Ayah, Allah said that Musa said to his people, If you disbelieve, you and all on the earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich (free of any need), Owner of all praise.}. Allah said, So they disbelieved and turned away. But Allah was not in need (of them). And Allah is Rich (free of any need), Worthy of all praise} meaning, He is far too Rich than to need His servants, and worthy of all praise in all His decisions and commandments.

The meaning of Allah's statement,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1300–1317]

And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is Ever All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} He has perfect watch over every soul, knowing what it deserves, He is the Watcher, and Witness of all things. Allah's statement,

And Allah is Ever All-Potent over that.} means, He is able to take you away and replace you with other people if you disobey Him. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, And if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes} Allah's statement, Whoever desires the rewards of this life, then with Allah is the reward of this worldly life and of the Hereafter.} means, O those whose ultimate desire is this life, know that Allah owns the rewards of this life and the Hereafter. Therefore, if you ask Allah for both, He will enrich you, award you and suffice for you. As Allah said, It is up to Us if we will, to increase or decrease the reward of whom we will, and We are All-Potent over that.} But of mankind there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world!" and for such there will be no portion in the Hereafter. And of them there are some who say : "Our Lord! Give us in this world that which is good and in the Hereafter that which is good, and save us from the torment of the Fire!" For them there will be allotted a share for what they have earned.} Whoever desires (by his deeds) the reward of the Hereafter, We give him increase in his reward, and We will grant him what he will for whom We like} until,

Jr wvm ' imm •'C ;> <{/{ ^ At % Lvi-iiS iJtS' ^See /iow We prefer one above another (in this world)). So Allah said here, (m.*Z iill iAnd Allah is Ever All- Hearer, All-Seer.) V& '& (rk 0} j\$ j ik '^ri £ if-M & \$ & dz 4 !yLij tii djl «ili Ijjii i o>j !*\$2 J 5^ i H& Sit S£ ^135. O you who believe! Stand out firmly for justice, as witnesses to Allah, even though it be against yourselves, or your parents, or your kin, be he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both. So follow not the lusts, lest you may avoid justice; and if you Talwu or Tu'ridii, it, verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do.) ^.n^ i]~ »h* ij* (*' OLS^V' j JJ Allb {fji I j—»jis Sil J0%£. <l>yidders^Jif'£jiui*"Qj^O'yiScl '^ . .a •<' If? •sr-'

Allah's statement, ik ias witnesses to Allah is similar to His statement, iAnd establish the testimony for Allah). Testimony should be delivered precisely, for the sake of Allah, thus making the testimony correct, truly just, and free of alterations, changes or deletions. This is why Allah said, & %) ieven though it be against yourselves,) meaning, give correct testimony, and say the truth when you are asked about it, even if harm will effect you as a consequence. Indeed, Allah shall make a way out and give relief for those who obey Him in every matter. Allah's statement, ior your parents, or your kin,) means, even if you have to testify against your parents and kin, do not compromise for their sake. Rather, give the correct and just witness even if they are harmed in the process, for the truth presides above everyone and is preferred to everyone. Allah's statement, *£*\$ 5* fei 3* ti£JS o[] ibe he rich or poor, Allah is a better Protector to both.) means, do not favor someone (in your testimony) because he is rich, or feel pity for him because he is poor, for Allah is their caretaker, a better Protector of them than you, and has better knowledge of what is good for them. Allah's statement, iSo follow not the lusts, lest you may avoid justice;) means, let not desire, lust or the hatred you have against others, lure you him njustice in your affairs. Rather, stand r justice in all situations.

Allah said; ih'jh y>W *il& <JSid 4A/id let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just: that is nearer to piety} when the Prophet jg sent 'Abdullah bin Rawahah to collect the tax on the fruits and produce of the Jews of Khaybar, they offered him a bribe so that he would go easy on them. He said; "By Allah! I have come to you from the dearest of the creation to me (Muhammad), and you are more hated by me than an equivalent number of apes and swine. However, my love for him (the Prophet jg) and hatred for you shall not prevent me from being just with you." On that, they said, "This (justice) is the basis which the heavens and earth were created." We will mention this Hadith later in Surat Al-Ma'idah (chapter 5) Allah willing. Allah's statement afterwards, iand if you Talwu or Tu'ridu} means, "Distort your testimony and change it", according to Mujahid and several others among the Salaf. 1 ' 1 Talwu, includes distortion and intentional lying. For instance, Allah said, >4H iAnd verily, among them is a party who Yalwuna (distort) the Book with their tongues (as they read)). Tu'ridu, includes hiding and withholding the testimony. Allah said, iWho hides it, surely, his heart is sinful}

The Prophet jg said, ij i ,;.H j~>- "The best witness is he who discloses his testimony before being m At-Tabari 9 :308

609 Surah 4. An-Nisa (Part-5) asked to do so. 11 Allah then warned, «i Hj Sit 4 Verily, Allah is Ever Well-Acquainted with what you do. \$ and will reward or punish you accordingly. 4' .a&&4 4' .,44s& 'A - ui 4''' 4'j i&L 'J&. j*j j;4 il36. O you who believe! Believe in Allah, and His Messenger, and the Book (the Qur'an) which He has sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He sent down to those before; and whosoever disbelieves in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day, tthen indeed he has strayed far away The Order to Have Faith after Believing Allah commands His faithful servants to adhere to all the elements of faith, its branches, pillars and cornerstones. This is not stated as mere redundancy, but from the view of completing faith and the continual maintenance of it. For instance, the believer proclaims in every prayer, iGuide us to the straight way which means, make us aware of the straight path and increase us in guidance and strengthen us on it. In this Ayah [4:136], Allah commands the believers to believe in Him and in His Messenger, just as He said elsewhere, iO you who believe! Have Taqwa of AUdlt, and believe in His Messenger, Allah's statement, m Muslim 3 : 1344

iatid the Book which He has sent down to His Messenger, refers to the Qur'an, while, iand the Scripture which He sent down to those before (him);} refers to the previously revealed divine Books. Allah then said, J-i> jii 'JZ. iand whosoever disbelieves in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers, and the Last Day, then indeed he has strayed far away.} meaning, he will have deviated from the correct guidance and strayed far away from its path. \$ 'M St& Z\$WS 2 \& 1 2 5\$ VjX '\$ ti¥ C/yi£}\ oj-ijJj uAl jAT^Oj V'j* at ajiiijf 1?J ,^aaau* J> -«j *u Oy Crv- 9J-= ,>i Uj' • t > >' .>*' i '< t'-s, (,r, < 'rt • - ^ 'jJjJu All* O' 4 'itpli-ir 4 «»* ol '»J ^J. ojA 4137. Verily, those who believe, then disbelieve, then believe (again), and (again) disbelieve, and go on increasing in disbelief; Allah will not forgive them, nor guide them on the (right) way.} 4138. Give to the hypocrites the tidings that there is for them a painful torment.} 4139. Those who take disbelievers for friends instead of believers, do they seek honor with them? Verily, then to Allah belongs all honor}. 4140. And it has already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the verses of Allah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in talk other than that; certainly in that case you would be like them. Surely, Allah will collect the hypocrites and disbelievers all together in Hell.}

Characteristics of the Hypocrites and Their Destination Allah states that whoever embraces the faith, reverts from it, embraces it again, reverts from it and remains on disbelief and increases in it until death, then he will never have a chance to gain accepted repentance after death. Nor will Allah forgive him, or deliver him from his plight to the path of correct guidance. This is why Allah said. ££> p& ft iAllah ivill not forgive them, nor guide them on the (right) way). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that his father said that Ahmad bin 'Abdah related that Hafs bin Jam!' said that Samak said that Ikrimah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented; Witt A) iand go on increasing in disbelief), "They remain on disbelief until they die." Mujahid said similarly.111 Allah then said, i^fXj C&A% Jfr iGive to the hypocrites the tidings that there is for them a painful torment.) Hence, the hypocrites have this characteristic, for they believe, then disbelieve, and this is why their hearts become sealed. Allah describes the hypocrites as taking the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, meaning they are the disbelievers' supporters in reality, for they give them their loyalty and friendship in secret. They also say to disbelievers when they are alone with them, "We are with you, we only mock the believers by pretending to follow their religion." Allah said, while chastising them for being friends with the disbelievers, mfa^AA) ido they seek honor,

with them?) Allah then states that honor, power and glory is for Him Alone without partners, and for those whom Allah grants such as in At-Tabari 9:315

qualities to. Allah said, if whoever desires honor, then to Allah belong all honor, and, and, y C0? yi4j 'O-«') iBut honor belongs to Allah, and to His Messenger, and to the believers, but the hypocrites know not}. The statement that honor is Allah's Alone, is meant to encourage the servants to adhere to their servitude to Allah and to be among His faithful servants who will gain victory in this life and when the Witnesses stand up to testify on the Day of Resurrection. Allah's statement, **• * **j iAnd it has already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the verses of Allah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in talk other than that; certainly in that case you would be like them . } The Ayah means, if you still commit this prohibition after being aware of its prohibition, sitting with them where Allah's Ayat are rejected, mocked at and denied, and you sanction such conduct, then you have participated with them in what they are doing. So Allah said. i(But if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them.} concerning the burden they will earn. What has already been revealed in the Book - as the Ayah says - is the Ayah in Surat Al-An'am [6], which was revealed in Makkah, J>j& SAY; Si' cffj }And when you see those who engage in false conversation about Our verses (of the Qur'an) by mocking at them, stay away from them}.

Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah [4:140] abrogated the Ayah in Surat Al- An'am, referring to the part that says here, i(But if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them}, and Allah's statement in Al-An'am, iTlwse ivho fear Allah, keep their duty to Him and avoid evil, are not responsible for them (the disbelievers) in any case, but (their duty) is to remind them, that they may have Taqiva}. Allah's statement, U l _ .1 * * t ' . A * a , \ *£- l'Z.'iu«V jjjoJi\ \OJ •>0^ . Uii£^ 'J3*^S)l liLi(lili J jy^ .yS^~^k2ijlijJlj[_^0 |w| 1%_y~ \j^S»ltu pi— Jfcj 4£rp- 4 j.j&Mj o»i^' cj'i- <i' iSurely, Allah will collect the hypocrites and disbelievers all together in Hell> means, just as the hypocrites participate in the Kufr of disbelievers, Allah will join them all together to reside in the Fire for eternity, dwelling in torment, punishment, enchained, restrained and in drinking boiling water. ji" ofj j\$2u J>2 JJ1 IjHZj J* jCi if* oli

4342. Those who wait and watch about you; if you gain a victory from Allah, they say: "Were we not with you?" But if the disbelievers gain a success, they say (to them): "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?" Allah will judge between you (all) on the Day of Resurrection . And never will Allah grant to the disbelievers a way (to triumph) over the believers.} Hypocrites Wait and Watch what Happens to Muslims Allah states that the hypocrites watch and await the harm that occurs to the believers, awaiting the time when the Muslim circumstances and religion are dissolved and the state of Kufr takes over. vt A if you gain a victory from Allah triumph, aid and booty, jS jjf \$&} A they say, "Were we not with you?"} hying to come closer to the believers with this statement. However, A But if the disbelievers gain a success,} by gaining victory over the believers sometimes, just as occurred during Uhud, for surely, the Messengers were tested, but the final victory is theirs. 4Sc-p'{ s: £& 4they say (to them), "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?"} meaning, did we not help you in secret and try our best to confuse the believers and weaken their resolve, until you gained victory over them? This statement of the hypocrites is an attempt

all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you) Allah's statement, (but it is He Who deceives them) means, He lures them further into injustice and misguidance. He also prevents them from reaching the truth in this life and on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said, (On the Day when the hypocrites - men and women - will say to the believers "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light! It will be said : "Go back to your rear! Then seek a light!") until, (And worst indeed is that destination). A Hadith states;

"Whoever wants to be heard of, Allah will make him heard of, and whoever wants to be seen, Allah will show him." *111 Allah's statement, (And when they stand up for Salath, they stand with laziness}. This is the characteristic of the hypocrites with the most honored, best and righteous act of worship, the prayer. When they stand for prayer, they stand in laziness because they neither truly intend to perform it nor do they believe in it, have humility in it, or understand it. This is the description of their outward attitude! As for their hearts, Allah said, (The intention of men) meaning, they do not have sincerity when worshipping Allah. Rather, they show off to people so that they gain closeness to them. They are often absent from the prayers that they can hide away from, such as the 'Isha' prayer and the Dawn prayer that are prayed in darkness. In the Two Sahih, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, (The heaviest prayers on the hypocrites are the 'Isha' and Dawn prayers. If they know their rewards, they will attend them even if they have to crawl. I was about to order someone to pronounce the Adhan for the prayer, then order someone to lead the prayer for the people, that order some men to collect fire-wood (fuel) ; then I would burn the houses around men who did not attend the (compulsory congregational) prayer.]2] In another narration, the Prophet (ﷺ) said, (Whoever does not attend the (compulsory congregational) prayer, I will burn his house around him.) 111 Fath Al-Bari 11:343 121 Fath Al-Bari 2 :53 and Muslim 1 :451

(By Him, in Whose Hand my soul is, if anyone of them had known that he would get a bone covered with good meat or two (small) pieces of meat between two ribs, he would have turned up for the prayer, and had it not been that the houses have women and children in them, I would burn their homes around them. Allah's statement, (And they do not remember Allah but little) means, during the prayer they do not feel humbleness or pay attention to what they are reciting. Rather, during their prayer, they are inattentive, jesting and avoid the good that they are meant to receive from prayer. Imam Malik reported that Al-'Ala' bin 'Abdur-Rahman said that Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, (This is the prayer of the hypocrite, this is the prayer of the hypocrite, this is the prayer of the hypocrite. He sits watching the sun until when it goes down between the two horns of the devil, he stands up pecks out four Rak'ahs (for 'Asr) without remembering Allah during them except little.)2] Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa'i also recorded it. At-Tirmidhi said "Hasan Sahih".]31 Allah's statement, (They are) swaying between this and that, belonging neither to these nor to those) 111 Fath Al-Bari 2 :248 and Muslim 1 :325 * Al-Muwatta 1 : 220 *3) Muslim 1 :434 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1 :497 and An-Nasa'i 1 :254

means that the hypocrites are swaying between faith and disbelief. So they are neither with believers inwardly or outwardly nor with disbelievers inwardly or outwardly. Rather, they are with the believers outwardly and with the disbelievers inwardly. Some of them would suffer fits of doubt, leaning towards these sometimes and towards those sometimes, (Whenever it flashes for them, they walk

therein, and when darkness covers them, they stand still}. Mujahid said; {(They are) staying between this and that, belonging neither to these “The Companions of Muhammad jfc;, Jt^ {nor to those}: the Jews.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Prophet jte, said, aThe example of the hypocrite is the example of the sheep wandering between two herds, sometimes she goes to one of them, and sometimes the other, confused over whom she should followv.» [1] Muslim also recorded it. 12’ This is why Allah said afterwards, Ji J*j} {and he whom Allah sends astray, you will not find for him a way.} meaning, whomever He leads astray from the guidance, ’A If J>} {For him you will find no Wali (guiding friend) to lead him (to 111 At-Tabari 9 :333 Muslim 4:2146

621 Surah 4. Ati-Nisa’ (Part-5) the right path)} because, ^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him}. So the hypocrites whom Allah has led astray from the paths of safety will never find a guide to direct them, nor someone to save them. There is none who can resist Allah’s decision, and He is not asked about what He does, while they all will be asked. 4144. O you who believe! Do not take disbelievers as friends instead of believers. Do you wish to offer Allah a manifest Sultan against yourselves?} 4145. Verily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depth (grade) of the Fire; no helper will you find for them.} 4146. Except those who repent, do righteous good deeds, depend on Allah, and purify their religion for Allah, then they will be with the believers. And Allah will grant the believers a great reward.} 4147. Why should Allah punish you if you have thanked (Him) and have believed in Him. And Allah is Ever All-Appreciative (of good), All-Knowing.}

The Prohibition of Wilayah with the Disbelievers

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1317–1327]

Allah forbids His believing servants from taking the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers. This includes being friends and associates of the disbelievers, advising them, being intimate with them and exposing the secrets of the believers to them. In another Ayah, Allah said, j <uaU <<* x o/> « - zsf)} \ *—*> 4JS' AOI

4Let not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, except if you indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself meaning, He warns you against His punishment if you fall into what He has prohibited. This is why Allah said here, iDo you wish to offer Allah a manifest Sultan against yourselves?} meaning, proof against you that warrants receiving His torment. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas commented; imanifest Sultan}, “The word Sultan in the Qur’an means proof.” There is an authentic chain of narration for this statement, which is also the saying of Mujahid, Ilcrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Kal) Al-Qurazi, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and An-Nadr bin ‘Arabi. The Hypocrites and the Friends of Disbelievers are in the Lowest Depth of the Fire, Unless they Repent Allah then states that, 4M S? 4-^" 4 <&&& \$1^ 4 Verily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire;} on the Day of Resurrection due to their tremendous Kufr. Al- Walibi [‘Ali bin Abi Talhah] said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4in the lowest depths (grade) of the Fire;} means, in the bottom of the Fire. Other scholars said that the Fire has ever lower depths just as Paradise had ever higher grades. Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Maslid said that, m At-Jabari 9 :339

ip 'jt 4'P 4 cs*0& i Verily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths (grade) of the Fire}, "Inside coffins of Fire that surround them, for they are closed and sealed in them." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that when Ibn Mas*ud was asked about the hypocrites, he said, "They will be placed in coffins made of fire and they will be closed in them in the lowest depth of the Fire." \$ Pr && ino helper will you findfor them.} to save them from their misery and painful torment. Allah then states that whoever among the hypocrites repents in this life, Allah will accept his repentance and sorrow, if his repentance were sincere and he then follows it by performing righteous deeds, all the while depending on his Lord. Allah said, iExcept those who repent (from hypocrisy), do righteous good deeds, depend on Allah, and purify their religion for Allah} replacing showing off with sincerity, so that their good deeds will benefit them, even if they were minute. ik&P c? ithen they zoill be with the believers.} on the Day of Resurrection, iilf yjj iAnd Allah tvill grant to the believers a great reivard.} Allah then states that He is too Rich to need anyone and that He only punishes the servants because of their sins, i'pX'3 i&pZ £} iWhy should Allah punish you if you have thanked (Him) and have believed in Him.} Ill At-Tabari 9 :339

624 Tafsir IbtI Kathir by correcting your actions and having faith in Allah and His Messenger sg, Jilt iArtd Allah is Ever All-Appreciative (ofgood), All-Knowing. Allah appreciates those who appreciate Him, and has knowledge of those whose hearts believe in Him, and He will give them perfect reward.

(ABRIDGED) The Qur'an is the revelation ofAllah's Own Words for the guidance of His creatures. Since the Qur'an is the primary source of Islamic teachings, the correct understanding of the Qur'an is necessary for every Muslim. The Tafsir of Ibn Kathir is the most renowned and accepted explanation of the Qur'an in the entire world. In it one finds the best presentation of Hadiths, History, and scholarly commentary. from unauthentic Hadiths. (ABRIDGED) VOLIU ME A GROUP OF SCHOLARS UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF SHAYKH SAFIUR-RAHMAN AL-MUBARAKPURI/MJJs

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TAFSIR (ABRIDGED) Parts 6, 7 & 8 (Surat An-Nisa, Verse 148 to the end of Surat Al-An'am)

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. **Incomplete Chains of Narration** The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - 'Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - ('Atiyah) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn 'Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Az-Zuhri [Muhammad bin Shihab] reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - 'Ikrimah reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced.

Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet (ﷺ), but they report from companions of the Prophet (ﷺ), while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-'Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, 'Ata' (bin Abi Rabah), 'Ata' Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rab' bin Anas, Ash-Sha'tibi, Qatadah, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. **Other Scholars After the Companions** The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet (ﷺ), his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Wak'at, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn 'Atiyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

J \ • T jU'i W3X&? > >•- i ^ 'J-V^ 4Uu 0_pdLlJl (jCi I \$hi >>i<<'v.'"* Si-"" s!***^« 44 **» <i' 6^5 J* o; ji C^~ ijxjS ^cjt '*s? Sil iji ,>t ijk<5 jil *jiit 4f:y X 4148. Allah does not like that the evil should be uttered in public except by him who has been wronged. And Allah is Ever All-Hearer, All-Knower.} 4149. Whether you disclose a good deed or conceal it, or, pardon an evil, verily, Allah is Ever Pardoning, All-Powerful.} The Permission to Utter Evil in Public, For One Who Was Wronged 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, ifi* U * 44 4Alldh does not like that the evil should be uttered in public "Allah does not like that any one should invoke Him against anyone else,

unless one was wronged. In this case, Allah allows one to invoke Him against whoever wronged him. Hence Allah's statement, {except by him who has been wronged.} Yet, it is better for one if he observes patience."111 Al-Hasan .xj-li'»^pr ^ 'j3& Lrij&^Ts*y jac\4 A ./ >,/ ^ '{.*<'> > '*A\ ® UjutCJal ^ y^ *ir in At-Tabari 9 :344

Throne praise Him saying, "All praise is due to You for Your forbearing even though You have perfect knowledge (in all evil committed)." Some of them supplicate, "All praise is due to You for Your forgiving even though You have perfect ability (to punish)." An authentic Hadith states, ii Ijaj <• Yj Ijlp lilt SO Y_> i JU U1 «No charity shall ever decrease wealth, and Allah will only increase the honor of a servant who pardons, and he who is humble for Allah's sake, then Allah will elevate his grade eJ);i os-; Ji uj'Vj. .u-1 ojj lyi jjJj iySIS UlJtc- 6jCa\> \i£. 'jy*\$ (*r« 4150. Verily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers and wish to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers saying, "We believe in some but reject others," and wish to adopt a way in between 4151. They are in truth disbelievers. And We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating torment.} 4152 . And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any of them (Messengers), We shall give them their rewards; and Allah is Ever Forgiving, Most Merciful .} Believing in Some Prophets and Rejecting Others is Pure Kufr Allah threatens those who disbelieve in Him and in His Messengers, such as the Jews and Christians, who differentiate between Allah and His Messengers regarding faith. They believe in some Prophets and reject others, following their desires, lusts and the practices of their forefathers. They do not follow any proof for such distinction, because there is no such proof. Rather, they follow their lusts and prejudices. I 1 * Muslim 4 :2001 .

The Jews, may Allah curse them, believe in the Prophets, except 'Isa and Muhammad, peace be upon them. The Christians believe in the Prophets but reject their Final and Seal, and the most honored among the prophets, Muhammad, peace be upon him. In addition, the Samirah (Samaritans) do not believe in any Prophet after Yuwsha' (Joshua), the successor of Mtisa bin "Imran. The Majus (Zoroastrians) are said to believe only in a Prophet called Zoroaster, although they do not believe in the law he brought them casting it behind them, and Allah knows best. Therefore, whoever rejects only one of Allah's Prophets, he will have disbelieved in all of them, because it is required from mankind to believe in every prophet whom Allah sent to the people of the earth. And whoever rejects one Prophet, out of envy, bias and personal whim, he only demonstrates that his faith in other Prophets is not valid, but an act of following desire and whim. This is why Allah said, iVerily, those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers... Thus, Allah describes these people as disbelievers in Allah and His Messengers; iand wish to make distinction between Allah and His Messengers} in faith, > •/. cyty isaying, "We believe in some but reject others," and wish to adopt a way in between .} Allah then describes them; iThey are in truth disbelievers.} meaning, their disbelief in the Prophet they claim to believe in is clear. This is because their claimed faith in a certain Messenger is not true, for had they truly believed in him, they would have believed in other Messengers, especially if the other Messenger has a stronger proof for his truthfulness. Or

19Surah 4. An-Nisa' (150 - 151) (Part-6) at least, they would have strived hard to acquire knowledge of the truth of the other Messenger. Allah said, iAttd We have prepared for the disbelievers a humiliating torment.} This is just punishment for belittling the Prophets whom they disbelieved in, by ignoring

what the Prophet brought to them from Allah, and because they are interested in the insignificant possessions of this world. Or, their behavior could be the result of their disbelief in the Prophet after they were aware of his truth, just as the Jewish rabbis did during the time of Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah jg. The Jews envied the Messenger because of the great prophethood that Allah gave him, and as a consequence, they denied the Messenger, defied him, became his enemies and fought against him. Allah sent humiliation upon them in this life, that shall be followed by disgrace in the Hereafter, 4\$ <Ui fol' i-ff ZJ.j7y} 4And they were covered with humiliation and misery, and they drew on themselves the wrath ofAllah.} in this life and the Hereafter. Allah's statement, **77 ' ' 4And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers and make no distinction between any ofthem,} This refers to the Ummah of Muhammad who believe in every Book that Allah has revealed and in every Prophetwhom Allah has sent. Allah said, 4The Messenger believes in what has been revealed to him from his Lord, and (so do) the believers. All of them believe in Allah.} (2 :285). Allah then states that He has prepared great rewards for them, tremendous favor and a handsome bounty,

}We shall give them their rewards;} because of their faith in Allah and His Messengers, -111 il&J^ iand Allah is Ever Forgiving, Most Merciful.} for their sin, if they have any. to&& jfc3'm \$ ol jil 6£ £s j«It lj2« 2 £\$5& ££ £f 0 U»j Ciiij fry to O'-J' 4*\$il\$£ 6*-; ^ea 4 lj5S V£ biiij 4\$yw pL 4253. The People of the Scripture (Jews) ask you to cause a book to descend upon them from heaven. Indeed, they asked Musa for even greater than that, when they said: "Show us Allah in public," but they were struck with a bolt of lightning far their wickedness. Then they worshipped the calf even after Al-Bayyinah had come to them. (Even) so We forgave them. And We gave Musa a clear proof of authority.} il54. And far their covenant, We raised over them the mount and (on the other occasion) We said: "Enter the gate prostrating (or bowing) with humility;" and We commanded them: "Transgress not on the Sabbath (Saturday)." And We took from them a firm covenant.} The Stubbornness of the Jews Muhammad bin Rah Al-Qurazi, As-Suddi and Qatadah said that the Jews asked the Messenger of Allah to cause a book to come down to them from heaven, just as the Tawrah was sent down to Musa. Ibn Jurayj said that the Jews asked the Messenger to cause books to come down to them addressed to so-and-so among them, testifying to the truth of what he was sent with.¹² ' The Jews only asked for this because of their stubbornness, defiance, rejection and disbelief. The disbelievers of Quraysh also asked for similar things from the Prophet, as is mentioned in Surat Al-Isra', At-Tabari 9:356, 357. 121 At-Jabari 9:357.

^ u s*^ j*-^ j 4Ah</ they say: "We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us;} (17:90) Allah said, itq & \)t& } ilindeed, they asked Musa for even greater than that, when they said, "Show us Allah in public," but they were struck with a bolt of lightning for their wickedness.} injustice, transgression, defiance and rebellion. This part was explained in Surat Al-Baqarah, j dj jifc \j—p- 3" \Sj ,£*• jtj> cJ *Ij} ^And (remember) when you said: "O Musa! We shall never believe in you until we see Allah plainly." But you were struck by a bolt of lightning while you were looking. Then We raised you up after your death, so that you might be grateful.} (2:55,56) Allah's statement, e&U iiS»2} iTheti they worshipped the calf even after Al-Bayyinah had come to them.} meaning, after they witnessed the tremendous miracles and unequivocal proofs at the hand of Musa in Egypt. They also witnessed the demise of their enemy, Fir'awn and his soldiers, when they all drowned in the sea. Yet soon after, when they passed by a people who were worshipping idols, they said to MUsa, ihy -ft u 4Make for us a god as they have gods.} Allah explains the story of the Jews

worshipping the calf in Surat Al-A'raf (7) and Surah Ta Ha (20) after MQsa went to meet with his Lord. When Musa returned, Allah decreed that in order for the Jews to earn accepted repentance, then those

23Surah 4. An-Nisd' (155 - 159) (Part-6 r. Jj ' ,r sot V.meaning, We commanded them to honor the Sabbath and honor what Allah prohibited them on that day. 'i^ujlj^ giftC)j?5 £3\$Ql %&}£\$**& 4&* &£. fit 4And We took from them a firm covenant. meaning, strong covenant. They rebelled, transgressed and committed what Allah prohibited by using deceit and trickery, as is mentioned in Surat Al-A'raf (7), \$ if 4^i\ ;>£. 4And ask them about the tenon that was by the sea.) »H &J» 'jfifs Cf jZ> '*C"V' filij 4»i (**& J*i:~£ (vp?1' 'A'fi & fijfj fijfci ^\$4 ofiS. 0* ^ zf C&j •y^+ Cj ijki Iij ^sii Jjij 0;i (ili* Vil i^JILLa i# C5 tfit& ^ £ v .*jck&j* yasa sj Sp \$4 '4 •A ^*3? v^*' ie oij v /f oft i£\ iai ilij j; 4^ *'«!»! fjp -}**• Hi 4155. Because of their breaking the covenant, and their rejecting the Aydt of Allah, and their killing the Prophets unjustly, and their saying: "Our hearts are Ghulf," nay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief, so they believe not but a little.)

4156. And because of their disbelief and uttering against Maryam a grave false charge .} 4157. And because of their saying, "We killed Al-Masdi 'Isa, son of Maryam, the Messenger of Allah," but they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared as that to them, and those who differ therein are full of doubts. They have no (certain) knowledge, they folloio nothing but conjecture. For surely; they killed him not.} 4158. But Allah raised him up unto Himself. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise.} 4159. And there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them.} The Crimes of the Jews The sins mentioned here are among the many sins that the Jews committed, which caused them to be cursed and removed far away from right guidance. The Jews broke the promises and vows that Allah took from them, and also rejected Allah's Ayat, meaning His signs and proofs, and the miracles that they witnessed at the hands of their Prophets. Allah said, 4and their killing the Prophets unjustly,} because their many crimes and offenses against the Prophets of Allah, for they killed many Prophets, may Allah's peace be upon them Their saying: 4k& VJL} 4"Our hearts are Ghulf,"} meaning, wrapped with covering, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ilcrimah, As-Suddi and Qatadah. This is similar to the what the idolators said, 4*\$l £4=^ a,, iSyis \$&)} m At-Tabari 9 :364

iAnd they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened from that to which you invite us.)" Allah said, ^ if inay, Allah has set a seal upon their hearts because of their disbelief,} It is as if they had given an excuse that their hearts do not understand what the Prophet says since their hearts are wrapped with coverings, so they claim. Allah said that their hearts are sealed because of their disbelief, as we mentioned before in the explanation of Surat Al-Baqarah. Allah then said, -ji iso they believe not but a little.} for their hearts became accustomed to Kufr, transgression and weak faith. The Evil Accusation the Jews Uttered Against Maryam and Their Claim that They Killed 'Isa Allah said, iAnd because of their (Jews) disbelief and uttering against Maryam a grave false charge.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas stated that the Jews accused Maryam of fornication.' ' This is also the saying of As- Suddi, Juwaybir, Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others. |2 ' This meaning is also apparent in the Ayah, as the Jews accused Maryam and her son of grave accusations: They accused her of fornication and claimed that 'Isa was an illegitimate son. Some of them even claimed that she was menstruating while

fornicating. May Allah's continued curse be upon them until the Day of Resurrection. The Jews also said. 111 At-Tabari 9:367. ' At-Tabari 9 :367

4"We killed Al-Masih, 'isa, son of Maryam, the Messenger of Allah,"} meaning, we killed the person who claimed to be the Messenger of Allah. The Jews only uttered these words in jest and mockery, just as the polytheists said, iO you to whom the Dhikr (the Qur'an) has been sent down! Verily, you are a mad man!} When Allah sent Isa with proofs and guidance, the Jews, may Allah's curses, anger, torment and punishment be upon them, envied him because of his prophethood and obvious miracles; curing the blind and leprous and bringing the dead back to life, by Allah's leave. He also used to make the shape of a bird from clay and blow in it, and it became a bird by Allah's leave and flew. Isa performed other miracles that Allah honored him with, yet the Jews defied and belied him and tried their best to harm him. Allah's Prophet Isa could not live in any one city for long and he had to travel often with his mother, peace be upon them. Even so, the Jews were not satisfied, and they went to the king of Damascus at that time, a Greek polytheist who worshipped the stars. They told him that there was a man in Bayt Al-Maqdis misguiding and dividing the people in Jerusalem and stirring unrest among the king's subjects. The king became angry and wrote to his deputy in Jerusalem to arrest the rebel leader, stop him from causing unrest, crucify him and make him wear a crown of thorns. When the king's deputy in Jerusalem received these orders, he went with some Jews to the house that Isa was residing in, and he was then with twelve, thirteen or seventeen of his companions. That day was a Friday, in the evening. They surrounded Isa in the house, and when he felt that they would soon enter the house or that he would sooner or later have to leave it, he said to his companions, "Who volunteers to be made to look like me, for which he will be my companion in Paradise?" A young man volunteered, but Isa thought that he was too young. He asked the question a second and third time, each time the young man volunteering, prompting Isa to say, "Well then, you will be that man." Allah made the young man look exactly like Isa, while a hole opened in the roof of

the house, and Isa was made to sleep and ascended to heaven while asleep. Allah said, it),\ J^ iAnd (remember) when Allah said: "O 'Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself."} When Isa ascended, those who were in the house came out. When those surrounding the house saw the man who looked like Isa, they thought that he was Isa. So they took him at night, crucified him and placed a crown of thorns on his head. The Jews then boasted that they killed 'Isa and some Christians accepted their false claim, due to their ignorance and lack of reason. As for those who were in the house with Isa, they witnessed his ascension to heaven, while the rest thought that the Jews killed Isa by crucifixion. They even said that Maiyam sat under the corpse of the crucified man and cried, and they say that the dead man spoke to her. All this was a test from Allah for His servants out of His wisdom. Allah explained this matter in the Glorious Qur'an which He sent to His honorable Messenger, whom He supported with miracles and clear, unequivocal evidence. Allah is the Most Truthful, and He is the Lord of the worlds Who knows the secrets, what the hearts conceal, the hidden matters in heaven and earth, what has occurred, what will occur, and what would occur if it was decreed. He said. &4M ibut they killed him not, nor crucified him, but it appeared as tlwt to them,} referring to the person whom the Jews thought was Isa. This is why Allah said afterwards, IQj hu*A ck&J« \$ iand those who differ therein are full of doubts. They have no (certain) knowledge, theyfollow nothing but conjecture.} referring to the Jews who claimed to

kill “Isa and the ignorant Christians who believed them. Indeed they are all in confusion, misguidance and bewilderment. This is why Allah said, its, Cj}

iFor surely; they killed him not.} meaning they are not sure that Isa was the one whom they killed. Rather, they are in doubt and confusion over this matter. iBut Allah raised him up unto Himself. And Allah is Ever All- Powerful,} meaning, He is the Almighty, and He is never weak, nor will those who seek refuge in Him ever be subjected to disgrace, 4C&.) 4All-Wise.} in all that He decides and ordains for His creatures. Indeed, Allah’s is the clearest wisdom, unequivocal proof and the most glorious authority. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Just before Allah raised Isa to the heavens, Isa went to his companions, who were twelve inside the house. When he arrived, his hair was dripping water and he said, There are those among you who will disbelieve in me twelve times after he had believed in me.’ He then asked, Who volunteers that his image appear as mine, and be killed in my place. He will be with me (in Paradise)?’ One of the youngest ones among them volunteered and Isa asked him to sit down. Isa again asked for a volunteer, and the young man kept volunteering and Isa asking him to sit down. Then the young man volunteered again and Isa said, *You will be that man,’ and the resemblance of Isa was cast over that man while Isa ascended to heaven from a hole in the house. When the Jews came looking for Isa, they found that young man and crucified him. Some of Isa’s followers disbelieved in him twelve times after they had believed in him. They then divided into three groups. One group, Al-Ya‘qQbiyyah (Jacobites), said, ‘Allah remained with us as long as He willed and then ascended to heaven.’ Another group, An-Nasturiyyah (Nestorians), said, The son of Allah was with us as long as he willed and Allah took him to heaven.’ Another group, Muslims, said, The servant and Messenger of Allah remained with us as long as Allah willed, and Allah then took him to Him.’ The two disbelieving groups cooperated against the Muslim group and they killed them. Ever since that happened, Islam was then veiled until Allah

sent Muhammad jg.” ’ This statement has an authentic chain of narration leading to Ibn ‘Abbas, and An-Nasal narrated it through Abu Kurayb who reported it from Abu Mu'awiyah.*2 Many among the Salaf stated that Isa asked if someone would volunteer for his appearance to be cast over him, and that he will be killed instead of ‘Isa, for which he would be his companion in Paradise. All Christians Will Believe in ‘Isa Before He Dies Allah said, ^ tyj •&» <£* 4*^ &4*^ iAnd there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them.} Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, iAnd there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death.} before the death of Isa, son of Maryam, peace be upon him. 13’ Al-‘Awfi reported similar from Ibn ‘Abbas.*4 * Abu Malik commented; 35 ‘h ibut must believe in him, before his death.} “This occurs after Isa returns and before he dies, as then, all of the People of the Scriptures will believe in him.”*5 The HadithsRegarding the Descent of ‘Isa Just Before the Day ofJudgement, and his Mission In the chapter about the Prophets in his Sahth, under, “The Descent of Isa, Son of Maryam,” Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu 111 Ibn Abi yatim 4:1110. * An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :489 * At-Tabari 9:380. > At-Tabari 9:380. * At-Tabari 9 :380.

30 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, r-> ^ ^ £~ai_> *^fc! ^*3 Cri (4^ 'jr5” ••AijwiJl j_jS5 «By Him in Whose Hands my soul is, the son ofMaryam ('Isa) will shortly descend among you as a just ruler, and will break the cross, kill the pig and abolish the JizyahJ Then there will

be an abundance of wealth and nobody will accept charitable gifts any more. At that time, one prostration will be better for them than this Ufa and all that is in it. Abu Hurayrah then said, "Read if you will, $\frac{1}{3}$ of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death. And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them."™ Muslim recorded this Hadith. [3] So, Allah's statement, 'before his death' refers to the death of Isa, son of Maryam. Another Hadith by Abu Hurayrah Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 'I will say Allahu Akbar from the mountain highway of Ar-Rawha' for Hajj, 'Umrah or both.'^ Muslim also recorded it. [e] Ahmad recorded that Abu A tax taken from non-Muslims, who are under the protection of the Muslim government. Fath Al-Bari 6:566. Muslim 1 :135 , and refer to Fath Al-Bari 5 :44 and 4:483 "Loud calling", as a Muhrim has to recite Talbiyah aloud when assuming the state of Ihram. [5 | Al-Jam'at 2:513. Ar-Rawha' is on route between Makkah and Al-Madinah, [e] Muslim 1 :135.

Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, 'Isa, son of Maryam, will descend and will kill the pig, break the cross, lead the prayer in congregation and give away wealth until it is no longer accepted by anyone. He will also abolish the Jizyah and go to Ar-Rawlid' from where he will go to perform Hajj, 'Umrah or both. Abu Hurayrah then recited, 'And there is none of the People of the Scripture, but must believe in him, before his death.' Hanzalah said, "Abu Hurayrah added, 'Will believe in Isa before Isa dies,' but I do not know if this was a part of the Prophet's Hadith or if it was something that Abu Hurayrah said on his own."! Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this Hadith. Another Hadith Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 'How will you be when Al-Masih, son of Maryam ('Isa) descends among you while your Imam is from among yourselves?' 21 Imam Ahmad 31 and Muslim also recorded this Hadith. Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet ﷺ said, 'Ahmad 2 :290. ' Fath Al-Bari 6 :566 131 Ahmad 2:272 and Muslim 1 :136-137.

The Prophets are paternal brothers; their mothers are different, but their religion is one. I, more than any of mankind, have more right to 'Isa, son of Maryam, for there was no Prophet between him and I. He will descend, and if you see him, know him. He is a well-built man, (the color of his skin) between red and white. He will descend while wearing two long, light yellow garments. His head appears to be dripping water, even though no moisture touched it. He will break the cross, kill the pig, and banish the Jizyah and will call the people to Islam. During his time, Allah will destroy all religions except Islam and Allah will destroy Al-Masih Ad-Dajjal (the False Messiah). Safety will then fill the earth, so much so that the lions will mingle with camels, tigers with cattle and wolves with sheep. Children will play with snakes, and they will not harm them. 'Isa will remain for forty years and then will die, and Muslims will offer the funeral prayer for him.* Abu Dawud also recorded it. Another Hadith In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah related to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ that he said, 'Cyrrus will be the first to believe in him.' 34 Muslim 4:433, Ahmad 2 :406, Abu Dawud: 4324, At-Jabari 9 :388.

fc ^ ajj i 'y : c)^i « |»^Jj aJ \1* JJ Xs* *1413! J-iii aIJj v !xl » j.lg- <bl V slJJ li-*J I c A^Ialla^i J^xIIaj
t !-Xj l N v^JLli! i4ii! p-SllLi- Ji jj :jUalli ! M p4 jji! i j*-a Lilli fLlJ! !j*U- iJl^U JiJ*3 a^j ^y-j* ttri^
«Jj*-i o^A^liJl w*»i ! JUaU j iciAL\$ i *\$j>)& c frLU ! ^J> ^JLJl ujl 115 »!i i^I! jjj> - *• - . *" * >: ^
k . *?*, ^ 4^0 l oJLj OJ l <Uli «77ie (Lasf,) Hour will not start until the Romans occupy Al- A'mdq or
Ddbiq.111 An army, comprised of the best of the people of the earth then, will come from Al-Madinah
and challenge them. When they camp face to face, the Romans will say, 'Let us fight those who
captured some of us.' The Muslims will say, 'Nay! By Allah, we will never let you get to our brothers.'
They ivill fight them. A third of the (Muslim) army will flee in defeat, and those are the ones whom
Allah will never forgive. Another third will be killed, and those are the best martyrs before Allah. The
last third will be victorious, and this third will never be stricken with Fitnah, and they will capture
Constantinople (Istanbul). While they are dividing war booty, after hanging their swords on olive trees,
Shaytan will shout among them, saying, 'Al-Masili (Ad-Dajjdl) has cornered your people'. They will
leave to meet Ad-Dajjdl in Ash-Sham. Tins will be a false warning, and when they reach Ash-Sham,
Ad- Dajjdl will then appear. When the Muslims are arranging their lines for battle and the prayer is
called for, 'Isd, son of Maryam, will descend and - lead them in prayer. When the enemy of Allah (the
False Messialt) sees him, he will dissolve just as salt dissolves in water, and ifany ofhim were left, he
would continue dissolving until he died. Allalt will kill him with the hand of 'Isa and will show the
Muslims his blood on his spear. Two cities close to Aleppo in Syria 121 Muslim 4:2221.

l N 1 «/ /ear of/ier f/ian Ad-Dajjal for you! If he appears while I am still among you, I will be his
adversary on your behalf. If he appears while I am not among you, each one will depend on himselfand
Allah will be the Helper of every Muslim after me. He is young, with very curly hair and his eye is
smashed. I thought that he looked like 'Abdul-Uzzd bin Qatan. Whoever lives long and meets Ad-
Dajjal, then let him recite the beginnings of Surat Al-Kahf. He will appear on a pass between Ash-Sham
(Syria) and Al-'Irdq. He will wreak havoc to the right and left. O Servants ofAllah! Holdfast .» We said,
'O Messenger of Allah! How long will he stay on earth?' He said, <*****£ {y.j fjt) "Forty days : One
day as long as a year, one day as long as a month and one day as long as a week. The rest of his days
will be as long as one ofyour ordinary days .» We said, 'O Messenger of Allah! As for the day that is
like a year, will the prayers of one day suffice for it?' He said, «J Ijjiil ' "No. Countfar its due measure
We said, 'O Messenger of Allah, how will his speed be on earth?' He said, id 14J 'pAjt-Xi pi JjIp
44iJlS» cJl's u J>l iiLJii j i>^i jiisji •i" \ f _f- z i , , , ; ,«• i *»• ^ lij^i > • , sj i • s ii > ' *»,< . " >> • \ \ * -
• Vj i Ull3> bill a-Ip j* fjt I l ^ l U.vtli i kiJUwaJ diS li-fl.) 0? J— iij-' ojlLUL Xp Jj4» if*>Bjl

37Surah 4. An-Nisd' (155 - 159) (Part-6) just like swarms of bees. He will summon a man full of youth
and will strike him with the sword once and will cut him into two pieces (and will separate between
them like) the distance (between the hunter and) the game. He will call the dead man and he will come,
and his face will radiant with pleasure and laughter. Afterwards (while all this is happening with Ad-
Dajjdl), Allah will send Al-Masili ('Isa), son ofMaryam down. He will descend close to the white
minaret to the east of Damascus. He will be wearing garments lightly colored with saffron and his
hands will be placed on the wings of two angels. Whenever he lowers his head droplets fall. Whenever
he raises his head, precious stones that look like pearls fall. No disbeliever can survive 'Isa's breath,
which reaches the distance of his sight. He will pursue Ad-Dajjal and will follow him to the doors of
(the Palestinian city of) Ludd where he will kill him . A group ofpeople who, by Allah's help, resisted

and survived Ad- Dajjal, will pass by 'Isa and he will anoint their faces and inform them about their grades in Paradise. Shortly afterwards, while this is happening with 'Isa, Allah will reveal to him, 7 raised a people of My creation that no one can fight. Therefore, gather My servants to At-Tur (the mountain of Musa in Sinai).' Then, Allah will raise Gog and Magog and they will swiftly swarm from every mound. Their front forces will reach Lake Tabariah (Sea of Galilee) and will drink all its water. The last of their forces will say as they pass by the lake, 'This lake once had water!' Meanwhile, 'Isa, Allah's Prophet, will be cornered along with his companions until the head of a bull will be more precious to them than a hundred Dinars to you today. 'Isa, Allah's Prophet, and his companions will invoke Allah for help and Allah will send An-Naghaf (a worm) into the necks of Gog and Magog! The morning will come, and they will all be dead as if it was the death of one soul. Afterwards, 'Isa, the Prophet of Allah, will come down with his companions to the low grounds (from Mount At-Tur). They will find that no space of a hand-span on the earth was free of their fat and rot (rotten corpses). "Isa, the Prophet of Allah, and his companions will seek Allah in supplication . Allah will send birds as large as the necks of camels. They will carry them (the corpses of Gog and Magog) and will throw them wherever Allah wills.

Afterwards, Allah will send rain that no house made of mud or animal hair will be saved from, and it will cleanse the earth until it is as clean as a mirror. The earth will be commanded (by Allah), 'Produce your fruits and regain your blessing.' Then, the group will eat from a pomegranate and will take shelter under the shade of its skin. Milk will be blessed, so much so that the milk-producing camel will yield large amounts that suffice for a large group of people. Meanwhile, Allah will send a pure wind that will overcome Muslims from under their arms and will take the soul of every believer and Muslim . Only the evildoers among people will remain. They will indulge in shameless public sex like that of donkeys. On them, the Hour will begin. 11 ^ Imam Ahmad and the collectors of the Sunan also recorded this Hadith. ,2' We will mention this Hadith again using the chain of narration collected by Ahmad explaining Allah's statement in Surat Al-Anbiy (chapter 21), iUntil, when Ya'juj and Ma'juj (Gog and Magog people) are let loose (from their barrier).} In our time, in the year seven hundred and forty-one, a white minaret was built in the Umayyad Masjid (in Damascus) made of stone, in place of the minaret that was destroyed by a fire which the Christians were suspected to have started. May Allah's continued curses descend on the Christians until the Day of Resurrection. There is a strong feeling that this minaret is the one that Isa will descend on, according to this Hadith. Another Hadith Muslim recorded in his Sahih that Ya'qub bin 'Asim bin "Urwah bin Mas'ud Ath-Thaqafi said, "I heard 'Abdullah bin 'Amr saying to a man who asked him, What is this Hadith that you are narrating? You claim that the Hour will start on such and such date.' He said, 'Subhan Allah (glory be to Allah) Muslim 4:2250. * Ahmad 4:181, Abu Dawud 4:496, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:499, An- Nasab in Al-Kubra 5:15, Ibn Majah 2 : 1356.

39 Surah 4. An-Nisr (155 - 159) (Part-6 Allah),' or he said, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah.' I almost decided to never narrate anything to anyone. I only said, "Soon, you will witness tremendous incidents, the House (the Ka'bah) will be destroyed by fire, and such and such things will occur." He then said, The Messenger of Allah said, ixiJ 3^ ^ji t, ^ j> JttoJl ^j>^} aJL* i J>. i'/j* <015' ^y> ,^1 <3il ililp jt ^HJ iii Jr>: p "jfe J&\& j4 ^ >t!ii Ikx: p jf- hi& J!^ t=rj 'J* 1Ea'& Jj it 4S* xS 'jt ^5a>-I ji j! hzJxj VI - jLlL ji - (*V^~I_> jlkJI ii>- ^llil jljJ< ^j§ Oil : Jli « ' vl : jJd jiklii^ jt4 .ijsn jjjsi; v'j

v ^uui Jli iui J> ,Uj olijVl ;Sl^ jUjiii ?Ujll Ui :jJJa £fj3 ^ jytai\ j*Jjj jxJv :Jli i *LJ ,j^>j>- k>fa. jAj <ilOJ ^ Jjij : Jli - jLh Jli ji - jk i\% - 5i,i Jji: :ju jl - lii J^ji p ft? p-° iij>-f jw i <4 oJlii - iidjl jlli; 1^1 : (d - Oj'Jx-i uAd-Dajjal will appear in my nation and will remain for forty. (The narrator doubts whether it is forty days, months, or years).Then, Allah will send down 'Isa, son of Maryam, looking just like 'Urwah bin Mas'ud and he will seek Ad-Dajjal and will kill him. People will remain for seven years with no enmity between any two. Allah will send a cool wind from As- Sham that will leave no man on the face of the earth who has even the weight of an atom of good or faith, but will capture (his soul) . Even if one of you takes refuge in the middle of a mountain, it will find him and capture (his soul). Afterwards, only the most evil people will remain. They will be as light as birds, with the comprehension of beasts. They will not know or enjoin righteousness or forbid or know evil. Shaytan will appear

to them and will say to them, 'Would you follow me.' They will say, 'What do you command us? He will command them to worship the idols. Meanwhile, their provision will come to them in abundance and their life will be good. Then the Trumpet will be blown and every person who hears it, will lower one side of his head and raise the other side (trying to hear that distant sound). The first man who will hear the Trumpet is someone who is preparing the zoater pool for his camels, and he and the people will swoon away. Allah will send down heavy rain and the bodies of people will grow with it. The Trumpet will be blown in again and the people will be resurrected and looking all about, staring. It will be said to them, 'O people! Come to your Lord,' iBut stop them, verily, they are to be questioned tJLL* i tJLJl slll-ii ;JU t i>_Jj «It will then be said, 'Bring forth the share of the Fire.' It will be asked, 'How many?' It will be said, 'From every one thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine.' That Day is when, the children will turn grey-headed and, if 4The Day when the Shin slml be laid bare

The Description of 'Isa, upon him be Peace

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1362–1379]

As mentioned earlier, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Adam narrated that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet said, OJj fa.A* j j\ s Muslim 4 :2258.

41 Surah 4. An-Nisr' (155 - 159) (Part-6 nlf you see 'Isa, know him. He is a well-built man, (the color of his skin) between red and white. He will descend while wearing light yellow garments. His head looks like it is dripping water, even though no moisture touched ff.ii111 In the Hadith that An-Nawwas bin Sam'an narrated, Ij JliP V 4j*ij lilj t'Jai U»U» lil t jl? V ^g ^ 4 ...£lj (OU V l ^Mwb 7TLJJ J9U ^I^J nHe will descend close to the white minaret to the east of Damascus. He will be wearing two garments lightly colored with saffron, having his hands on the wings of two angels. Whenever he lowers his head, drops will fall off of it. Whenever he raises his head, precious [ewels like pearls will fall off of it. No disbeliever can survive 'Isa's breath, and his breath reaches the distance of his sight. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sjg said, «I met Musa on the night of my Ascension to heaven .» The Prophet jg then described him saying, as I think, «He was a tall person with hair as if he was one of the men from the tribe of Shanu'ah.n^ The Prophet jg further said, 5b ^ Aj Ojjj Li ^-Jb\j\ if j>JI «7 met 'Isa/ The Prophet s§ described him saying, 'He was of moderate height and was red-faced as if he had just come out of a bathroom , I saw Ibrahim whom I resembled

more than any of his children did. '»141 I 1 * Abu Dawud 4 :498 121 Muslim 4:2250. The name of a tribe, descending from the Qahtani Arabs I4 ' Fath Al-Bari 6 :493, Muslim 1 : 154

in his right eye. He looked exactly as Ibn Qatan, and he was leaning on the shoulder of a man while circling the House. I asked, 'Who is this man?' I was told, 'He is Al-Masih Ad-Dajjal.' [" Al-Bukhari recorded that Salim said that his father said, "No, By Allah! The Prophet jSg did not say that Isa was of red complexion but said, tja! l Vi .. * j liU i4«a5UI> k_jjb\ ill t J I : I^JU i ?|jui :C.lat — JI* J J ^ — Jli j»-J •jjlji ^LJI iJlijJl : jJli ?IJU {ft :oJi i ililL> <l!p iLlp tWhile 1 was asleep circumambulating the Ka'bah (in my dream), 1 suddenly saw a man of brown complexion and ample hair walking between two men with water dripping from his head. I asked, 'Who is this?' The people said, 'He is the son of Maryam.' Then I looked behind and I saw a red-complexioned, fat, curly-haired man, blind in the right eye, which looked like a bulging out grape. I asked, 'Who is this?' They replied, 'He is Ad-Dajjal.' The person he most resembled is Ibn Qatan .n"121 Az-Zuhri commented that Ibn Qatan was a man from the tribe of Khuza'ah who died during the time of JahUyyah. This is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Allah's statement, iAnd on the Day of Resurrection, he ('Isa) will be a witness against them} Qatadah said, "He will bear witness before them that he has delivered the Message from Allah and that he is but a servant of His." In a similar statement in the end of Surat Al-Ma'idah, (O* oi' tJ-iTrl iAnd (remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection) : "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Did you say unto men..."} until, Muslim 1 :154. 121 FathAl-Bari 6:550.

4Almighty, the All-Wise.} 0* p^ ol»-1 'r^t. ijJl* vi/ili ji C'j* 4^k *5® rt^lj 52» 'jr •A* ijJl ji ^*J ^iU}. J^i tc oEi>; cijljji'j |^ jsf 4 jj***1^ 'j^ (T^- M 4>>\$H} -iyjii'j *ji^ 4:%>£}£ ^160. For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful for them certain good foods which had been lawful for them-and for their hindering many from Allah's way;} 4161. And their taking of Riba though they were forbidden from taking it, and their devouring men's substance wrongfully. And We have prepared for the disbelievers among them a painful torment.} 4162. But those among them who are well-grounded in knowledge, and the believers, believe in what has been sent down to you and what was sent down before you; and those who perform the Saldh, and give Zakah and believe in Allah and in the Last Day, it is they to whom We shall give a great reward.} Some Foods Were Made Unlawful for the Jews Because of their Injustice and Wrongdoing Allah states that because of the injustice and transgression of the Jews, demonstrated by committing major sins, He prohibited some of the lawful, pure things which were previously allowed for them. This prohibition could be only that of decree, meaning that Allah allowed the Jews to falsely interpret their Book and change and alter the information about what was allowed for them. They thus, out of exaggeration and extremism in the religion, prohibited some things for themselves. It could also mean that in the Tawrah, Allah prohibited things that were allowed for them before. Allah said, 4)> oi 'i-r** if- (j-* - 1* Jits-l xjr{ 4>l£=> y}

45Surah 4. An-Nisa' (160 - 162) (Part-6) 4AU food was lawful to the Onldren of Israel, except what Isrd'il made unlawful for himself before the Tawrah was revealed.} We mentioned this Ayah before, which means that all types of food were allowed for the Children of Israel before the Tawrah was revealed, except the camel's meat and milk that Israll prohibited for himself. Later, Allah prohibited many things in the Tawrah. Allah said in Surat Al-An'am (chapter 6), foo S} J^=> 'jjUji u yt^ s< 4And unto those who are Jews, Weforbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and We forbade them the fat

of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs or their entrails, or is mixed up with a bone. Thus We recompensed them for their rebellion. And verily. We are Truthful.} This means, We prohibited these things for them because they deserved it due to their transgression, injustice, defying their Messenger and disputing with him. So Alldh said; o*- oil* /jit fms 4For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful to them certain good foods which had been lawful to them, and for their hindering many from Allah's way.} This Ayah states that they hindered themselves and others from following the truth, and this is the behavior that they brought from the past to the present. This is why they were and still are the enemies of the Messengers, killing many of the Prophets. They also denied Muhammad and Isa, peace be upon them. Allah said, 4& ij£% ij£l' 4And their taking of Riba' though they were forbidden from taking it,} Allah prohibited them from taking Riba', yet they did so

46 Tafoir Ibn Kathir using various kinds of tricks, ploys and cons, thus devouring people's property unjustly. Allah said, i'C—Q C'j* (*r iAnd We have prepared for the disbelievers among them a painful torment Allah then said, 'i i&y iBut those among them who are well-grounded in knowledge...} firm in the religion and full of beneficial knowledge. We mentioned this subject when we explained Surah Al 'Imran (3). The Ayah; iand the believers...} refers to the well-grounded in knowledge; o-* Uj kiUj L ibelieve in what has been sent down to you and what was sent down before you;} Ibn 'Abbfis said, "This Ayah was revealed concerning 'Abdullah bin Salam, Thalabah bin Sa'yah, Zayd bin Sa'yah and Asad bin TJbayd who embraced Islam and believed what Allah sent Muhammad jg with. Allah said, iand give Zakdh,} This could be referring to the obligatory charity due on one's wealth and property, or those who purify themselves, or both. Allah knows best. 4&» iand believe in Allah and in the Last Day,} They believe that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah, believe in Resurrection after death and the reward or punishment for the good or evil deeds. Allah's statement, ilt is they,} thosewhom the Ayah described above,

47Surah 4. An-Nisd' (163 - 165) (Part-6) mxm '• fs < rV my' y.my yy my »--f JOJ^A) •>-•"- ~-y, > j*%5, />< «- -vi"<i"ja jj dll'^Jtaj ^-va (4 0tejs&s&tfs by>^2 Jb-^1' 1^ 4^o whom We s/ia// give a great reward.} means Paradise. xr jQl txjt q *i^ ai gy dl £Xji -*5?Sl 2k XLXjlj ic.V(s ' >" S>. > / !< / / . OJj^J VJi'j Cs-iZJ #<\$ t3« oj ii& * *\$&£ ^tUc. p|^iV> jU 'ilijj jl» ifplii^sO £y iill & teX k& m iU \$ £ ojfi \$& «# 'M m Verily, We have sent the revelation to you as We sent the revelation to Nuh and the Prophets after him; We (also) sent the revelation to Ibrahim, Ismd'il, Ishaq, Ya'qub, and Al-Asbdt, (the offspring of the twelve sons of Ya'qub) 'Isa, Ayyub, Yunus, Hdrun, and Sulaymdn ; and to Ddwud We gave the Zabiir.} And Messengers We have mentioned to you before, and Messengers We have not mentioned to you, and to Musa Allah spoke directly.} Messengers as bearers of good news and warning, in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the (coming of) Messengers. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All- Wise.}

Yasa' (Elisha), Zakariya (Zachariya), Yahya (John) and Isa (Jesus), and their leader, Muhammad sg. Several scholars of Tafsir also listed Dhul-Kifl among the Prophets. Allah's statement, iand Messengers We have not mentioned to you,} means, "there are other Prophets whom We did not mention to you in the Qur'an.' The Virtue ofMusa Allah said, ii' fej} iand to Musa Allah spoke directly.} This is an honor to Musa, and this is why he is called the Kalim, he whom Allah spoke to directly. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded that 'Abdul-Jabbar bin 'Abdullah said, "A man came to Abu Bakr bin

‘Ayyash and said, I heard a man recite (this Ayah this way): *And to Allah, Musa spoke directly.*” Abu Bakr said, ‘Only a disbeliever would recite it like this.’ Al-A‘ash recited it with Yahya bin Withab, who recited it with Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami who recited it with ‘Ali bin Abi Talib who recited with the Messenger of Allah *sg, iL±Z=Ci iit %i} iand to Musa Allah spoke directly.}*”[n Abu Bakr bin Abi Ayyash was so angry with the man who recited the Ayah differently, because he altered its words and meanings. That person was from the group of Mu‘tazilah who denied that Allah spoke to Musa or that He speaks to any of His creation. We were told that some of the Mu‘tazilah once recited the Ayah that way, so one teacher present said to him, “O son of a stinking woman! What would you do concerning I 1 * At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat: 3325.

Allah’s statement, *i&& C&j& it as} 4And when Musa came at the time and place appointed by Us, and his Lord spoke to him,} [7:143]?”* The Shaykh meant that the later Ayah cannot be altered or changed. The Reason Behind Sending the Prophets is to Establish the Proof Allah said, *.Messengers as bearers of good news as well as of warning,} meaning, the Prophets bring good news to those who obey Allah and practice the good things that please Him. They also warn against His punishment and torment for those who defy His commandments. Allah said next, iii o’?> j»> vX j&i£ ujBJ SjS yii} 4in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the Messengers. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise.}* Allah sent down His Books and sent His Messengers with good news and warnings. He explained what He likes and is pleased with and what He dislikes and is displeased with. This way, no one will have an excuse with Allah. Allah said in other Ayat, *Jt ui x&i Vjj£ \ja£\$ i\ &} 1 -i -s 4And if We had destroyed them with a torment before this, they would surely have said: "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger, we should certainly have followed Your Ayat, before we were humiliated and disgraced."*} and. *iLiji Cj 4And if (We had) not (sent you to the people of Makkah) in case a calamity should seize them for (the deeds) that their hands have sent forth.}*

It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas‘ud said that the Messenger of Allah said, *Yj *>; iij& u>^1 *£»k^^ JL>-1 Nj illiJ ‘^TJ 3* i 1 * cr! iJl ‘r^ 4-4 -iu> J»-i S? *£’ o* j4*5’ a*No one is more jealous than Allah. *Tltis is why He prohibited all types of sin committed in public or secret. No one likes praise more than Allah, and this is why He has praised Himself. No one likes to give excuse more than Allah, and this is why He sent the Prophets as bearers of good news and as warners. In another narration, the Prophet^ said, 3% ilij iui a*And this is why He sent His Messengers and revealed His Books, *n*11 j*^ 3^ ^ Si. '§& jfi^ 6i &&^ *5;# -j W ijX ^ oj \$i\ £a&£ J-& \$&&& 0% 4\$.%&!» 0* 3^5 crfjVlj A 3)> ii/S2 ojj f,S23 (j*. ^366. Buf A//d/i bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you; He has sent it down with His knowledge, and the angels bear witness. And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Witness . 4167. Verily, those who disbelieve and prevent (others) from the path of Allah; they have certainly strayed far away.} 4166. Verily, those who disbelieve and did wrong; Allah will not forgive them, nor will He guide them to a way.} 4169. Except the way of Hell, to dwell therein forever; and this is ever easy for Allah.} 4270. O mankind! Verily, there has come to you the Messenger with the truth from your Lord. So believe in him, it is better (1’ Fath Al-Bari8 :146 and Muslim 4 :21 14*

for you. But if you disbelieve, then certainly to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Ever All- Knowing, All-Wise.> Allah’s statement *i& ^ Verily, We have inspired you emphasized the Prophet’s prophethood and refuted the idolaters and People of the Scripture who denied*

him. Allah said, \$ vl 'it £]> iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you,» meaning, even if they deny, defy and disbelieve in you, O Muhammad, Allah testifies that you are His Messenger to whom He sent down His Book, the Glorious Qur'an that, lb U ii'A. y.b ife iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. Allah then said, i-i+n-m 4He has sent it down with His knowledge, The knowledge of His that He willed His servants to have access to. Knowledge about the clear signs of guidance and truth, what Allah likes and is pleased with, what He dislikes and is displeased with, and knowledge of the Unseen, such as the past and the future. This also includes knowledge about His honorable attributes that no sent Messenger or illustrious angel can even know without Allah's leave. Similarly, Allah said, 4And they will never compass anything of His knowledge except that which He wills. and,

53Surah 4. An-Nisr' (166 - 170) (Part-6 4but they will never compass anything ofHis knowledge.) Allah's statement. iand the angels bear witness.) to the truth of what you came with and what was revealed and sent down to you, along with Allah's testimony to the same, 4And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Witness.) Allah said. 4 'x_»J -6 «j»l 0* rfj' 6',^ iVerily, those who disbelieve and prevent (others)from the path ofAllah, they have certainly strayedfar away.) For they are disbelievers themselves and do not follow the truth. They strive hard to prevent people from following and embracing Allah's path. Therefore, they have defied the truth, deviated, and strayed far away from it. Allah also mentions His judgment against those who disbelieve in His Ayat, Book and Messenger, those who wrong themselves by their disbelief and hindering others from His path, committing sins and violating His prohibitions. Allah states that He will not forgive them; 4&J* r+i-Q, inor will He guide them to a way (that is, ofgood.) 4^ 1%£> 4Except the way of Hell, to dwell therein forever...) and this is the exception. Allah then said, PJ *M ^ 40 mankind! Verily, there has come to you the Messenger with the truth from your Lord, so believe in him, it is better for you.) This Ayah means, Muhammad jg has come to you with guidance, the religion of truth and clear proof from Allah. Therefore, believe in what he has brought you and follow him, for this is better for you. Allah then said, 4cj?J\$J 4 A 'j/52 o\o)

J assniss '•« j^I_L3o"5 > 'Jtibtj ill ^\lfUj1T4l4^=>j 4J»t 8Ej«S» Si *But *f you disbelieve, then certainly to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth.} Allah is far too rich than to need you or your faith, and no harm could ever affect Him because of your disbelief. Allah said in another Ayah, ~irAJ ^Q 6j<utOjjJ*^Sjj£ OuSJ&&\$&\$&{£&\$&& j*j jivl tyj JBj^ iff) 2i\ LLj. J>jf\ j iAnd Musa said: "If you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich (Free of all needs), Owner of all praise."} Allah said here, «Oi 4\$ <L>%} iAnd Allah is Ever All-Knowing,} He knows those who deserve to be guided, and He will guide them. He also knows those who deserve deviation, and He leads them to it, iAll-Wise} in His statements, actions, legislation and all that He decrees. Ci\ jhIif \$»' jc ijiji-j Vj 'fz=c->i 4 IjLi "5 jiV*^ "£> !£*££ 0>j5 Jo? Ji, '-fuil ^ —iA> i?i6 4 C jS& JS j 1*5 %i&Q Jfej £. I#J %£ IJ^s ^ \$> !*iVf 4 c;

55Surah 4. An-Nisa (171) (Part-6 4171. O People of the Scripture! Do not exceed the limits in your religion, nor say ofAllah except the truth. Al-Masih 'Isa, son ofMaryam, was (no more than) a Messenger of Allah and His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit from [created by] Him; so believe in Allah and His Messengers. Say not: "Three!" Cease! (it is) better for you. For Allah is (the only) One God, hallowed be He above having a son. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all

that is in the earth. And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs.} Prohibiting the People of the Book From Going to Extremes in Religion Allah forbids the People of the Scriptures from going to extremes in religion, which is a common trait of theirs, especially among the Christians. The Christians exaggerated over Isa until they elevated him above the grade that Allah gave him. They elevated him from the rank of prophethood to being a god, whom they worshipped just as they worshipped Allah. They exaggerated even more in the case of those who they claim were his followers, claiming that they were inspired, thus following every word they uttered whether true or false, be it guidance or misguidance, truth or lies. This is why Allah said, 4^ 4They took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, juIjup : ljljj jlp u(lllji o^l»f CS . j > N aDo not unduly praise me like the Christians exaggerated over ‘Isa, son of Maryam. Verily, I am only a servant, so say, 'Allah's servant and His Messenger. 's* 1 ' This is the wording of Al-Bukhari.121 111 Ahmad 1:23. 121 Fath Al-Bari6 :551

Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said that a man once said, “O Muhammad! You are our master and the son of our master, our most righteous person and the son of our most righteous person...” The Messenger of Allah said, ji Alii il liiklJi ij \£\ u» y- <3j* j 6! 4-r' ** 3“j «&' xi- «0 people/ Say what you have to say, but do not allow Shaytan to trick you. I am Muhammad bin 'Abdullah, Allah's servant and Messenger. By Allah! I do not like that you elevate me above the rank that Allah has granted me."11 ' Allah's statement, inor say ofAllah except the truth. means, do not lie and claim that Allah has a wife or a son, Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. Allah is glorified, praised, and honored in His might, grandure and greatness, and there is no deity worthy of worship nor Lord but Him. Allah said; £jjj 'fjf* j'Cj jit £it iAl-Masih 'Isd, son of Maryam, was (no more than) a Messenger of Allah and His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spiritfrom [created by] Him “Isa is only one of Allah's servants and one of His creatures. Allah said to him, ‘Be’, and he was, and He sent him as a Messenger. ‘Isa was a word from Allah that He bestowed on Maryam, meaning He created him with the word ‘Be’ that He sent with Jibril to Maryam. Jibril blew the life of Isa into Maryam by Allah's leave, and Isa came to existence as a result. This incident was in place of the normal conception between man and woman that results in children. This is why Isa was a word and a Ruh (spirit) created by Allah, as he had no father to conceive him. Rather, he came to existence through the word that Allah uttered, ‘Be,’ and he was, through the life that Allah sent with Jibril. Allah said, m Ahmad 3:153.

3 ot .££ JS J^S vi c^f j^>=»t iAl-Masili ['Isa], son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed aivay before him. His mother [Maryam] was a Siddfqah. They both ate food.} And Allah said, \$ '& JVS y'> Jt \$ XJr Ji 4Verily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created himfrom dust, then (He) said to him: "Be!" - and he was.} i_.lt t+Lfj Jf 4And she who guarded her chastity, We breathed into her (garment) and We made her and her son ['Isa] a sign for all that exits.} (21 :91) ~Csf Jf °-!*! (y'O^ 4And Maryam, the daughter of 'Imran who guarded her chastity,} and Allah said concerning the Messiah, 4& £2* j& Vi ji 5[] 4He ['Isa] ivas not more than a servant. We granted Ourfavor to him.}

The Meaning of “His Word and a spirit from Him”

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1379–1382]

‘Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah said that the Ayah, 'And His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit from [created by] Him;’ means, He said,

and he was. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ahmad bin Sinan Al-Wasiti said that he heard Shadh bin Yahya saying about Allah’s statement, 'And His Word, which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit from [created by] Him;’ “Isa was not the word. Rather, ‘Isa came to existence because of the word.”², Al-Bukhari recorded that Qatadah bin As-Samit said that the Prophet said, 'If anyone testifies that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah Alone Who has no partners, and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger, and that ‘Isa is Allah's servant and Messenger and His Word which He bestowed on Maryam and a spirit created by Him, and that Paradise is true and Hell is true, then Allah will admit him into Paradise with the deeds which he performed .»[31 In another narration, the Prophet said, '...through any of the eight doors of Paradise he wishes .» Muslim¹ also recorded it. Therefore, ‘Ruh from Allah’, in the Ayah and the Hadith is similar to Allah’s statement. 'And has subjected to you all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth and all that is between them and the creatures therein and He is the Most Gracious the Most Merciful.’¹¹¹ ‘Abdur-Razzaq 1:177. Ibn Abi Hatim : 6310. 131 Fath Al-Bari 6 :547 ' Muslim 1 :57.

Surah 4. An-Nisr (171) (Part-6) is in the earth ; it is all from Him.} meaning, from His creation, “from Him’ does not mean that it is a part of Him, as the Christians claim, may Allah’s continued curses be upon them. Saying that something is from Allah, such as the spirit of Allah, the she-camel of Allah or the House of Allah, is meant to honor such items. Allah said, 'This is the she-camel of Allah...’ and, 'and sanctify My House for those who circumambulate it.’ An authentic Hadith states, 'I will enter on my Lord in His Horned All these examples are meant to honor such items when they are attributed to Allah in this manner. Allah said, 'so believe in Allah and His Messengers.} believe that Allah is One and Alone and that He does not have a son or wife. Know and be certain that “Isa is the servant and Messenger of Allah. Allah said after that, 'I say not: "Three!"’ do not elevate Isa and his mother to be gods with Allah. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. In Surat Al-Ma'idah (chapter 5), Allah said, 'Surely, disbelievers are those who said : "Allah is the third of the three.” But there is none who has the right to be worshipped but One God.} Allah said by the end of the same Surah, 'is cf u' itr-l Jli *f} *** Al-Bukhari 13:246, from the lengthy Hadith about the intercession

And (remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O son of Maryam! Did you say unto men : 'Worship me'?" and in its beginning, 'I am the Messiah, son of Maryam.) The Christians, may Allah curse them, have no limit to their disbelief because of their ignorance, so their deviant statements and their misguidance grows. Some of them believe that Isa is Allah, some believe that he is one in a trinity and some believe that he is the son of Allah. Their beliefs and creeds are numerous and contradict each other, prompting some people to say that if ten Christians meet, they would end up with eleven sects! The Christian Sects Said bin

Batriq, the Patriarch of Alexandria and a famous Christian scholar, mentioned in the year four hundred after the Hijrah, that a Christian Council convened during the reign of Constantine, who built the city that bears his name. In this Council, the Christians came up with what they called the Great Trust, which in reality is the Great Treachery. There were more than two thousand patriarchs in this Council, and they were in such disarray that they divided into many sects, where some sects had twenty, fifty or a hundred members, etc.! When the king saw that there were more than three hundred Patriarchs who had the same idea, he agreed with them and adopted their creed. Constantine who was a deviant philosopher - gave his support to this sect for which, as an honor, churches were built and doctrines were taught to young children, who were baptized on this creed, and books were written about it. Meanwhile, the king oppressed all other sects. Another Council produced the sect known as the Jacobites, while the Nestorians were formed in a third Council. These three sects agreed that 'Isa was divine, but disputed

regarding the manner in which Isa's divinity was related to his

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1382–1391]

humanity; were they in unity or did Allah incarnate in Isa! All three of these sects accuse each other of heresy and, we

believe that all three of them are disbelievers. Allah said, iCease! (it is) better for you.) meaning, it will be better for you. 'A&& >j iit (£\$ iFor Allah is (the only) One God, hallowed be He above having a son .) and He is holier than such claim. 4To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. And Allah is All-Sufficient as a Disposer of affairs,) for all are creatures, property and servants under His control and disposal, and He is the Disposer of the affairs. Therefore, how can He have a wife or a son among them, i% %& U oy-Ji y:) 4He is the originator of the heavens and the earth. How can He have children.) and <0\ jje? ijiuJ] iAnd they say: "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son. Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing.") Up to His saying, ^Alone.) If- < ,*j Z3Li\ Vj & fo* ol ji) tL_jt Cjlji > \«V> ii/SLitj iyScU tilj <Vi» oj (<*•*£.» (**->. o; (*V 4172. Al-Masih will never be too proud to be a servant of Allah, nor the angels who are the near (to Allah). And

62 Tafstr Ibn Kathir whosoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} il73. So, as for those who believed and did deeds of righteousness, He will give them their (due) rewards - and more out of His bounty. But as for those who refused His worship and were proud, He will punish them with a painful tortment. And they will not find for themselves besides Allah any protector or helper.} The Prophets and Angels Are Never too Proud to Worship Allah Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that, "proud", means insolent. Qatadah said that, iAl-Masih will never be too proud to be a servant of Allah nor the angels who are near (to Allah). [they] will never be arrogant,' Allah then said. 4U: 4l 5J 4And whosoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} on the Day of Resurrection. Then, Allah will judge between them with His judgment that is never unjust or wrong. 4'&-^ai cA (**•»&.> r+A-y? (& } 4So, as for those who believed and did deeds of righteousness, He will give their (due) rewards, and more out of His bounty.} Allah will award them their full rewards for their righteous actions and will give them more of His bounty, kindness, ample mercy and favor. Cufr V%} 4But as for those who refused His

worship and were proud,} out of arrogance, they refused to obey and worship Him, 4C^% 6j& oJ> oi\$ 0/4£ [il At-Tabari 9 :424

63Surah 4. An-Nisd' (174 - 175) (Part-6 4He will punish them with a painful torment. And they will not find far themselves besides Allah any protector or helper.) In another Ayah, Allah said, ojiip iw&C 4Verily! Those who scorn My worship, they will surely enter Hell in humiliation,} degradation, disgrace and dishonor, for they were arrogant and rebellious. ip: ft & P\ ff\$ && pc % <&} 4 i4\ -j *4 pJ 4 f&P* |yPA'ip 4174. O mankind! Verily, there has come to you a convincing proof from your Lord; and We sent down to you a manifest light.} 4175. So, as far those who believed in Allah and held fast to [depend on] Him, He will admit them to His mercy and grace (i.e. Paradise), and guide them to Himself by a straight path.} The Description of the Revelation that Came From Allah Allah informs all people that a plain, unequivocal proof has come to them from Him. One that eradicates all possibility of having an excuse, or falling prey to evil doubts. Allah said, & Pi i and We sent down to you a manifest light.} that directs to the Truth. Ibn Jurayj and others said, "It is the Qur'an." 111 i.H ipp; p ip: ft* > 4So, as far those who believed in Allah and held fast to [depend on] Him,} by worshipping Him and relying on Him for each and every thing. Ibn Jurayj said that this part of the Ayah means, "They believe in Allah and hold fast to the Qur'an." *2 ' 111 At-Tabari 9:428. At-Tabari 9 :429

j *4 jfc 4 4He will admit them to His mercy and grace,) meaning, He will grant them His mercy and admit them into Paradise, and will increase and multiply their rewards and their ranks, as a favor and bounty from Him. i and guide them to Himself by a straight path.) and a clear way that has no wickedness in it or deviation. This, indeed, is the description of the believers in this life and the Hereafter, as they are on the straight and safe path in matters of action and creed. In the Hereafter, they are on the straight path of Allah that leads to the gardens of Paradise. 'J vmm \ . i v ^ 4 ". A c£jiil \jjl I I3JCLjo6i jil ^pijUdf ll IojSullyLjlj o]j a ,j\$; 'i; ji & ifcr o> to a s» i ^A \$ as ar4% a jz q^;%% uju & iitj j^ iit\$ gtoa& ^^ Ai E *lJr 4176. They ask you for a legal verdict. Say: "Allah directs (thus) about Al-Kalalah. If it is a man that dies leaving a sister, but no child, she shall have half the inheritance, and [in her case] he will be her heir if she has no children . If there are two sisters, they shall have two-thirds of the inheritance; if there are

brothers and sisters, the male will have twice the share of the female. (Thus) does Allah make clear to you (His Law) lest you go astray. And Allah is the All-Knower of everything."} This is the Last Ayah Ever Revealed, the Ruling on Al- Kalalah Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara' said that the last Surah to be revealed was Surah Bara'ah (chapter 9) and the last Ayah to be revealed was, yjq IJi} iThey ask you for a legal verdict . Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "The Messenger of Allah came visiting me when I was so ill that I fell unconscious. He performed ablution and poured the remaining water on me, or had it poured on me. When I regained consciousness, I said, 'I will only leave inheritance through Kal&lah, so what about the inheritance that I leave behind?' Allah later revealed the Ayah about Fara'id (inheritance (4: 1 1])." 12) The Two Sahfys and also the Group recorded it. In one of the wordings, Jabir said that the Ayah on inheritance was revealed; iThey ask you for a legal verdict. Say: "Allah directs (thus) about Al-Kaldlah.}^ The wording of the Ayah indicates that the question was about the Kalalah, Hi iSay: "Allah directs (thus)...} We mentioned the meaning of Kalalah before, that it means the crown that surrounds the head from all sides. This is why the scholars stated that Kalalah

pertains to one who dies and 1,1 FathAl-B6ri 8:117. 121 Ahmad 3 :298 131 Path Al-Bari 12 :26 and Muslim 3 :1235. 141 Fath Al-Bari 12:5, Muslim 3:1235, Abu Dawud 3:308, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 6 : 273 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 4 :59 and Ibn Majah 1 :462

<{Whatsoever is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and honor will remain forever.} Allah said here, ^leaving no child,} referring to the person who has neither children, nor parents. What testifies to this, is that Allah said afterwards, C+li JLi-1 iLeaving a sister, she shall have half the inheritance.} Had there been a surviving ascendant, the sister would not have inherited anything, and there is a consensus on this point. Therefore, this Ayah is referring to the man who dies leaving behind neither descendants nor ascendants, as is apparent for those who contemplate its meaning. This is because when there is a surviving parent, the sister does not inherit anything, let alone half of the inheritance. Ibn Jarir and others mentioned that Ibn ‘Abbas and Ibn Az- Zubayr used to judge that if a person dies and leaves behind a daughter and a sister, the sister does not inherit anything. They would recite, &JUa lilx% %£& Ifctf o\} ilf it is a man that dies, leaving a sister, but no child, she shall have half the inheritance.} They said that if one leaves behind a daughter, then he has left behind a child. Therefore the sister does not get anything. The majority of scholars disagreed with them, saying the daughter gets one half and the sister the other half, relying on other evidence. This Ayah (4:176 above) gives the sister half of the inheritance in the case that it specifies. As for giving the sister half in other cases, Al-Bukhari recorded that Sulayman said that Ibrahim reported to Al-Aswad that he said, “During the time of the Messenger of Allah Mu'adh bin Jabal gave a judgment that the daughter gets one half and the sister the other half.” ' Al-Bukhari recorded that Huzayl bin Shurahbll m Al-Bukhari : 6741

68 Tafcir Ibn Katfur said, “Abu Musa Al-Ash‘ari was asked about the case when there was a daughter, grand-daughter and sister to inherit. He said, The daughter gets one-half and the sister one-half.’ Go and ask Ibn Mas‘ud, although I think he is going to agree with me.’ So Ibn Mas‘ud was asked and was told about Abu Musa’s answer, and Ibn Mas‘ud commented, I would have deviated then and would not have become among those who are rightly guided. I will give a judgment similar to the judgment given by the Prophet jg. The daughter gets one-half, the grand-daughter gets one-sixth, and these two shares will add up to two-thirds. Whatever is left will be for the sister.’ We went back to Abu Musa and conveyed to him Ibn Mas‘ud’s answer and he said, *Do not ask me (for legal verdicts) as long as this scholar is still among you.”111 Allah then said, ds a j? fi 4uu 4 . . . and he will be her heir if she has no children.} This Ayah means, the brother inherits all of that his sister leaves behind if she has no surviving offspring or parents. If she has a surviving parent, her brother would not inherit anything. If there is someone who gets a fixed share in the inheritance, such as a husband or half brother from the mother’s side, they take their share and the rest goes to the brother. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ajSi jJ-j I iGive the Fardi'd to its people, and whatever is left is the share of the nearest male relative Allah said, i'i'j 6 j&t os£3 ar 4} iff there are two sisters, they shall have two-thirds of the inheritance;} meaning, if the person who dies in Kalalah has two sisters, they get two-thirds of the inheritance. More than two sisters 111 Al-Bukhari : 6736. 121 Fath Al-Bari 12:17, Muslim 3:1233.

share in the two-thirds. From this Ayah, the scholars took the ruling regarding the two daughters, or more, that they share in the two-thirds, just as the share of the sisters (two or more) was taken from the Ayah about the daughters, 4 L. jy tL-i^ (there are) only daughters, two or more, their share is two thirds of the inheritance.} (4:11). Allah said, i'0X Jii fe\$H % IJf 4i/ f/iere are brothers and sisters, the male will have twice the share of the female.} This is the share that the male relatives (sons, grandsons, brothers) regularly get, that is, twice as much as the female gets. Allah said, 4(Thus) does Allah make clear to you...} His Law and set limits, clarifying His legislation, 4*^ oty iLest you go astray.} from the truth after this explanation, 42-& ij} iAnd Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} Allah has perfect knowledge in the consequences of everything and in the benefit that each matter carries for His servants. He also knows what each of the relatives deserves from the inheritance, according to the degree of relation he or she has with the deceased. Ibn Jarir recorded that Tariq bin Shihab said that Tjmar gathered the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg once and said, "I will give a ruling concerning the Kalalah that even women will talk about it in their bedrooms." A snake then appeared in the house and the gathering had to disperse. 'Umar commented, 'Had Allah willed this ('Umar's verdict

regarding the Kalalah) to happen, it would have happened."

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1391–1393]

111 AMabari 9:439.

The chain of narration for this story is authentic. Al-Hakim, Abu 'Abdullah An-Naysaburi recorded that 'Umar bin Al- Khattab said, *Had I asked the Messenger of Allah jg regarding three things, it would have been better for me than red camels. (They are:) who should be the Khallfah after him; about a people who said, *We agree to pay Zakdh, but not to you (meaning to the Khallfah),' if we are allowed to fight them; and about the Kalalah." Al-Hakim said, "Its chain is Sahth according to the Two Shaykhs, and they did not recorded it." Ibn Jarir also said that it was reported that 'Umar said, "I feel shy to change a ruling that Abu Bakr issued. Abu Bakr used to say that the Kalalah is the person who has no descendants or ascendants."*2 * Abu Bakr's saying is what the majority of scholars among the Companions, their followers and the earlier and later Imams agree with. This is also the ruling that the Qur'an indicates. For Allah stated that He has explained and made plain the ruling of the Kalalah, when He said, % fJLja J p&oj& i(Thus) does Allah makes clear to you (His Law) lest you go astray. And Allah is the All-Knower of everything And Allah knows best. 111 Al-HSkim 2:304. At-Tabari 9:437.

The Tafslrof SuratAl-Md9idah (Chapter - 5)

The Virtues of SuratAl-Md*idahi When It was Revealed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1393–1396]

At-Tirmidhi recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "The last Surahs to be revealed were Surat Al-Ma'idah and Surat Al-Fath (chapter 48)." At-Tirmidhi commented, "This Hadith is Hasan, Gharib."W and it was also reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that the last Surah to be revealed was, 4 'j <li i iWhen there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest,^*21 Al-Hakim collected a narration similar to that of At-Tirmidhi in his Mustadrak, and he said, "It is Sahih. according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs

and they did not record it.”[3] Al- Hakim narrated that Jubayr bin Nufayr said, “I performed Hajj once and visited ‘A’ishah and she said to me, ‘O Jubayr! Do you read (or memorize) Al-Ma’idah ?’ I answered ‘Yes.’ She said, It was the last Surah to be revealed. Therefore, whatever permissible matters you find in it, then consider (treat) them permissible. And whatever impermissible matters you find in it, then consider (treat) them impermissible.” Al-Hakim said, “It is Sahih according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs and they did not record it.”¹⁴¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Mahdi related that Mu‘awiyah bin Salih added this statement in the last Hadith, “I (Jubayr) also asked ‘A’ishah about the Messenger of Allah’s conduct and she answered by saying, The Qur’an.” An-Nasal also recorded it.’ * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :436 ' Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi8 :437 '3| Al-Hakim 2:311. '4| Al-Hakim 2 :31 1 ' Ahmad 6 :188 and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra: 1 1138

ii-g,i^0P *— j*£ & C% iip.pPp l&i iyjl ip: pjf \ \$£} ph\ vj -ifjd iji V ip; ^f (3s } C £z if Sj)> £1; Jpf 'ij> (ty-iyj (^J jj U-il f'yi-l vl2j' ^jlf Vj ->~U)' X> ifJit "ij f^Lf to J 4\$ i ^ ^jis jl ^ id jjs^2 *J liiCS “Eu Si' oj, Si' 'jijfj o!>ju!j ^" ^1 ji lyjLo "slj ifjill'j jll J& [pj^j i ' ihi the Name ofAlldlj, Most Gracious, Most Merciful.} 41. O you who believe! Fulfill (your) obligations. Lawful to you (for food) are all the beasts of cattle except that which will be announced to you (herein), game (also) being unlawful when you assume Ihrdm. Verily, Allah commands that which He wills.} 42 . O you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of the symbols ofAllah, nor of the Sacred Month, nor of the Hady brought for sacrifice, nor the garlands, nor the people coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord. But when you finish the Ihrdm, then hunt, and let not the hatred ofsome people in (once) stopping you from Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) lead you to transgression . Help you one another in Al-Birr and At-Taqwa, but do not help one another in sin and transgression. And have Taqwd of Alldlt. Verily, Allah is severe in punishment.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that a mein came to ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud and said to him, “Advise me.” He said, “When you hear Allah’s statement, <*ip: <#£} \$0 you who believe!} then pay full attention, for it is a righteous matter thatHe is ordaining or an evil thing thatHe is forbidding.” Khaythamah said, “Everything in the Qur’an that reads, 40 you who believe!} reads in the Tawrah, ‘O you who are in need.’” Allah said,

4Fulfill (your) obligations.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and others said that ‘obligations’ here means treaties. ' Ibn Jarir mentioned that there is a consensus for this view. Ibn Jarir also said that it means treaties, such as the alliances that they used to conduct.'2 ' ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented: 4 Ijijl ^ 40 you who believe! Fulfill (your) obligations.} “Refers to the covenants, meaning, what Allah permitted, prohibited, ordained and set limits for in the Qur’an. Therefore, do not commit treachery or break the covenants. Allah emphasized this command when He said, 4And those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Allah has commanded to be joined,} until, iM£> iunhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).}^ Ad-Dahhak said that, 4;m 4Fulfill your obligations.} “Refers to what Allah has permitted and what He has prohibited. Allah has taken the covenant from those who proclaim their faith in the Prophet jg and the Book to fulfill the obligations that He has ordered for them in the permissible and the impermissible.” Explaining the Lawful and the Unlawful Beasts Allah said, At-Tabari 9:450. 121 At-Tabari 9 :449 ' At-Tabari 9 :452

iLawful to you (forfood) are all the beasts of cattle} camels, cows and sheep, as Al-Hasan, Qatadah and several others stated. ' Ibn Jarir said that this Tafsir conforms to the meaning of (‘beasts of cattle’) that

the Arabs had. We should mention that Ibn Umar, Ibn ‘Abbas and others relied on this Ayah as evidence to allow eating the meat of the fetus if it is found dead in the belly of its slaughtered mother. ' There is a Hadith to the same effect collected in the Sunan of Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah and narrated by Abu Said who said, “We asked, ‘O Messenger of Allah! When we slaughter a camel, cow or sheep, we sometimes find a fetus in its belly, should we discard it or eat its meat?’ He said. Q54I SISI ol5i jl “Eat it if you want, because its slaughter was fulfilled when its mother was slaughtered At-Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Hasan.”³ ' Abu Dawud recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of AllahM said, «Proper slaughter of the fetus is fulfilled with the slaughter of its mother . » Only Abu Dawud collected this narration.*⁴ Allah’s statement, «jS3E iexcept that which will be announced to you (herein),} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that it refers to, “The flesh of dead animals, blood and the meat of swine.”⁵ ' Qatadah said, “The meat of dead animals and animals slaughtered without Allah’s Name being pronounced at the time of slaughtering.”⁶ It appears, and Allah knows best, that the Ayah refers to Allah’s other statement, At-Tabari 9:455. ' At-Tabari 9:456. ' Abu Dawud 3 :252 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :48 and Ibn Majah ' Abu Dawud 3 :253 ' At-Tabari 9:458. ' At-Tabari 9:458.

Surah 5: Al-Maidah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1397–1402]

Opening •! -"ir vif' .Hj .* j«' -5} p^» ^ off zj Kj&Vj 4Forbidden to you (for food) are : Al-Maytah (the dead animals), blood, the flesh of swine, and what has been slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that xohich has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal .5[5:3], for although the animals mentioned in this Ayah are types of permissible cattle (except for swine), they become impermissible under the circumstances that the Ayah (5:3) specifies. This is why Allah said afterwards, Je jui l*j U iUnless you are able to slaughter it (before its death) and that which is sacrificed (slaughtered) on An-Nusub (stone altars)\$ as the latter type is not permissible, because it can no longer be slaughtered properly. Hence, Allah's statement, & C -3) ft iLawful to you are all the beasts of cattle except that which will be announced to you,\$ means, except the specific circumstances that prohibit some of these which will be announced to you. Allah said, <)j- jpr 44P\$ igrme (also) being unlawful when you assume Ihrdm.\$ Some scholars said that the general meaning of 'cattle' includes domesticated cattle, such as camels, cows and sheep, and wild cattle, such as gazzelle, wild cattle and wild donkeys. Allah made the exceptions mentioned above (dead animals blood, flesh of swine etc.), and prohibited hunting wild beasts while in the state of Ihr&m. It was also reported that the meaning here is, "We have allowed for you all types of cattle in all circumstances, except what We excluded herewith for the one hunting game while in the state of Ihr&m." Allah said,

76 Tafsfr Ibn Kathtr &%&% J&i £>))But ifone is forced by necessity, without willful disobedience, and not transgressing, then, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) This Ayah means, "We allowed eating the meat of dead animals, when one is forced by necessity, under the condition that one is not transgressing the limits or overstepping them." Here, Allah states, "Just as We allowed the meat of cattle in all conditions and circumstances, then do not hunt game when in the state of Ihrdm, for this is the decision of Allah, Who is the Most Wise in all that He commands and forbids." So Allah said; cpc a iVerily, Allah commands that which He wills.) The Necessity of Observing the Sanctity of the Sacred Area and the Sacred Months Allah continues, 40 you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of Sha'd'ir Allah (the symbols ofAllah),) Ibn 'Abbas said, "Sha'd'ir Allah means the rituals of Hey/." Mujahid said, "As-Safa and Al-Marwah, and the sacrificial animal are the symbols of Allah."*2 * It was also stated that Sha a'ir Allah is what He prohibited. Therefore, it means, do not violate what Allah prohibited. Allah said afterwards, «?CJf£*^ inor of the Sacred Month,) for you are required to respect and honor the Sacred Month and to refrain from what Allah forbade during it, such as fighting. This also lays emphasis on avoiding sins during that time. As Allah said; At-Tabari 9 :463 At-Tabari 9 :463

They ask you concerning fighting in the Sacred Month. Say, "Fighting therein is a great (transgression) and, G? 411I Jci vj-e 4 Verily, the number of months with Allah is twelve months (in a year). Al-Bukhari recorded in his Sahih that Abu Bakrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said during the Farewell Hajj, 'fij. l*5l tli\ ol^GJl Jii jU ^ 3laG,l jj JU jij ji i<yjl Ifi; i «77ie division of time has returned as it was when Allah created the Heavens and the earth . The year is twelve months, four of which are sacred: Three are in succession, (they are:) Dhul- Qa'dah, Dluil-Hijjah and Muharram, and (the fourth is) Rajab of (the tribe of) Mudar which comes between Jumada (Ath- Thaniyah) and Sha'banJ This Hadith testifies to the continued sanctity of these months until the end of time. Taking the Hadj/2] to the Sacred House of Allah, Al- Ka'bah Allah's statement, iif&i% 3ZL\ *;> itior of the Hady brought for sacrifice, nor the garlands means, do not abandon the practice of bringing the Hady (sacrificial animals) to the Sacred House, as this ritual is a form of honoring the symbols of Allah. Do not abandon the practice of garlanding these animals on their necks, so that they are distinguished from other cattle. This way, it will be Fath Al-Bari 10:10. The animal offered as a sacrifice by the pilgrims.

Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (1 - 2) (Part-6 The Necessity of Preserving the Sanctity and Safety of those who Intend to Travel to the Sacred House Allah said, 4^y>p fjrj cA inor the people coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord.) The Ayah commands: Do not fight people who are heading towards the Sacred House of Allah, which if anyone enters it, he must be granted safe refuge. Likewise, those who are heading towards the Sacred House seeking the bounty and good pleasure of Allah, must not be stopped, prevented, or frightened away from entering the Sacred House. Mujahid, 'Ata', Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mutarrif bin 'Abdullah, 'Abdullah bin 'Ubayd bin TJmayr, Ar-Rabf bin Anas, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Qatadah and several others said that, 4seeking the bounty of their Lord.) refers to trading. ' A similar discussion preceded concerning the Ayah; 4There is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord (during pilgrimage by trading).} Allah said; 4&jj} 4and pleasure.} Ibn 'Abbas said that the word 'pleasure' in the Ayah refers to, "seeking Allah's pleasure by their Hajj." 'Ikrimah, As-Suddi and Ibn Jarir mentioned that this Ayah was revealed concerning Al-Hutam bin Hind Al-Bakri, who had raided the cattle belonging to the people of Al-Madlnah. The following year, he wanted to perform 'Umrah to the House of Allah and some of the Companions wanted to attack him on his way to m At-Tabari 9 :480-481

so Tafstr Ibn Kathir the House. Allah revealed, |>jrj j* ff/Li cIji juT:) 4>or the people coming to the Sacred House (Makkah), seeking the bounty and good pleasure of their Lord.^ [I HuntingGame is Permissible Alter IhramEnds Allah said, iWX v^} 4But when you finish the Ihram, then hunt,} When you end your Ihram, it is permitted for you to hunt game, which was prohibited for you during Ihram. Although this Ayah contains a command that takes effect after the end of a state of prohibition (during Ihram in this case), the Ayah, in fact, brings back the ruling that was previously in effect. If the previous ruling was an obligation, the new command will uphold that obligation, and such is the case with recommended and permissible matters. There are many Ayat that deny that the ruling in such cases is always an obligation. Such is also the case against those who say that it is always merely allowed. What we mentioned here is the correct opinion that employs the available evidence, and Allah knows best. Justice isAlways Necessary Allah said, iand let not the hatred of some people in (once) stopping you from Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) lead you to transgression (and hostility on your part).}

The meaning of this Ayah is apparent, as it commands: Let

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1402–1429]

not the hatred for some people, who prevented you from reaching the Sacred House in the year of Hudaibiyyah, make you transgress Allah's Law and commit injustice against them in retaliation. Rather, rule as Allah has commanded you, being At-Tabari 9:472,475. The narrations about the cause of revelation for this Ayah are not authentic

81 Surah 5 . At-Mu'tah (1-2) (Part-6) just with every one. We will explain a similar Ayah later on, && *51 & *34 Anrf let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just: that is nearer to piety which commands: do not be driven by your hatred for some people into abandoning justice, for justice is ordained for everyone, in all situations. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Zayd bin Aslam said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ and his Companions were in the area of Al-Hudaibiyyah when the idolators prevented them from visiting the House, and that was especially hard on them. Later on, some idolators passed by them from the east intending to perform 'Umrah. So the Companions of the Prophet ﷺ said, 'Let us prevent those {from 'Umrah) just as their fellow idolators prevented us.' Thereafter, Allah sent down this Ayah." ' Ibn Abbas and others said that "Shana'an" refers to enmity and hate. Allah said next, if £ 4 Help you one another in Al-Birr and At-Taqwa; but do not help one another in sin and transgression Allah commands His believing servants to help one another perform righteous, good deeds, which is the meaning of 'Al-Birr', and to avoid sins, which is the meaning of 'At-Taqwa'. Allah forbids His servants from helping one another in sin, 'Ithm' and committing the prohibitions. Ibn Jarir said that, "Ithm means abandoning what Allah has ordained, while transgression means overstepping the limits that Allah set in your religion, along with overstepping what Allah has ordered concerning yourselves and others." *2 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, ji Ljll ilil «Support your brother whether he was unjust or the victim of injustice . He was asked, "O Messenger of Allah! We know about helping him when he suffers injustice, so what about helping 111 At-Tabari 9 :478 ' At-Tabari 9:490.

jr vmm ' *v 4&2P him when he commits orfcj l£2%ui£^ffi.pV£;\$S injustice?" He said, tt. |, - > t i >> « • " p-UaJl ^j_j 4 W. ..^_»J >o^_kj ill-li 0Prevent and stop him from committing injus- tice, and this represents support to Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith through Hushaym.*2 * Ahmad recorded that one of the Companions of the Prophet ﷺ narrated the Hadith, Ljuj ^jji •>i^ fiti JU Tj >ti)i ijuj v ^jji^ •jUisf^ «77ie believer who mingles with people and is patient with their annoyance, earns more reward than the believer who does not mingle with people and does not observe patience with their annoyance . »*3 Muslim*4 * recorded a Hadith that states, ^ V*r£** fji jfr f <j4 yr-Vl jf *J jls ^iX JJ US <y &ri' J\ us *ei ^ Jus *4^ p-fj*" (>? *^4* u^~i ^ 'V*i£** f)i j\ •He iw/io caZ/s to a guidance, will earn a reward similar to the 111 Ahmad 3:99. *21 FathAl-Bari 5:117. *31 Ahmad 5 :365 * Muslim 4:2060.

rewards of those who accept his call, until the Day of Resurrection, without decreasing their rewards. Whoever calls to a heresy, will carry a burden similar to the burdens of those who accept his call, until the Day of Resurrection, without decreasing their own burdens . X&K * \$ & & Zj ijLO &^ Cj •<£ u pi 'f\ ViMb &> lift ^ 55 fMi * !#* •,J^ f&S^ 4 V& % PVP <Pi '(M jfctf Jfc ^ sft4 'M J* i <\$3. Forbidden to you (for food) are: Al-Maytah (the dead animals), blood, the flesh of swine, and that which has been

slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah, and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal - unless you are able to slaughter it (before its death) - and that which is sacrificed (slaughtered) on An-Nusub (stone altars). (Forbidden) also is to make decisions with Al-Azlam (arrows) (all) that is Fisq (disobedience and sin). This day, those who disbelieved have given up all hope of your religion; so fear them not, but fear Me. This day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed My favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion. But as for him who is forced by severe hunger, with no inclination to sin (such can eat these above mentioned animals), then surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. The Animals that are Unlawful to Eat Allah informs His servants that He forbids consuming the mentioned types of foods, such as the Maytah, which is the animal that dies before being properly slaughtered or hunted. Allah forbids this type of food due to the harm it causes, because of the blood that becomes clogged in the veins of the dead animal. Therefore, the Maytah is harmful, religiously and physically, and this is why Allah has prohibited it. The only

exception to this ruling is fish, for fish is allowed, even when dead, by slaughtering or otherwise. Malik in his Muwatta, also Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah in their Sunan, Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Hibban in their Sahih, all recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was asked about seawater. He said, "O Jahl Ja "Its water is pure and its dead are permissible." The same ruling applies to locusts, as proven in a Hadith that we will mention later. Allah's statement, "Blood..." This refers to flowing blood, according to Ibn 'Abbas and Said bin Jubayr, and it is similar to Allah's other statement, "Blood poured forth..." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas was asked about the spleen and he said, "Eat it." They said, "It is blood." He said, "You are only prohibited blood that was poured forth." Abu 'Abdullah, Muhammad bin Idras Ash-Shafii recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "We were allowed two dead animals and two (kinds of) blood. As for the two dead animals, they are fish and locust. As for the two bloods, they are liver and spleen. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal, Ibn Majah, Ad-Daraqutni and Al-Bayhaqi also recorded this Hadith through 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, who is a weak narrator. 111 Abu Dawud 1:64, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:224, An-Nasal 1:50, Ibn Majah 1:136, Ibn Khuzaymah 1:59, Ibn Hibban 2:272. 121 Musnad Ash-Shafi'i 12:173, Ahmad 2:97, Ad-Daraqutni 4:272, Al-Bayhaqi 1:254, and others. It is considered authentic due to its many routes.

Allah's statement, "the flesh of swine..." includes domesticated and wild swine, and also refers to the whole animal, including its fat, for this is what the Arabs mean by Lahm or "flesh". Muslim recorded that Buraydah bin Al-Husayb Al-Aslami said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Who plays Nardshir (a game with dice that involves gambling) is just like the one who puts his hand in the flesh and blood of swine." 111 If this is the case with merely touching the flesh and blood of swine, so what about eating and feeding on it? This Hadith is a proof that Lahm means the entire body of the animal, including its fat. It is recorded in the Two Sahih, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Allah made the trade of alcohol, dead animals, pigs and idols illegal. The people asked, "O Allah's Messenger! What about the fat of dead animals, for it was used for greasing the boats and the hides; and people use it for lanterns?" He said, "No, it is illegal." 121 In the Sahih of Al-Bukhari, Abu Sufyan narrated that he said to Heraclius, Emperor of Rome, "He (Muhammad) prohibited us from

eating dead animals and blood.” Allah said, *And that which has been slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah.* } 1,1 Muslim 4:1770. Fath Al-Bari 4 :495 , Muslim 3 :1207

86 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Therefore, the animals on which a name other than Allah was mentioned upon slaughtering it, is impermissible, because Allah made it necessary to mention His Glorious Name upon slaughtering the animals, which He created. Whoever does not do so, mentioning other than Allah’s Name, such as the name of an idol, a false deity or a monument, when slaughtering, he makes this meat unlawful, according to the consensus. Allah’s statement, *and that which has been killed by strangling...^ either intentionally or by mistake, such as when an animal moves while restrained and dies by strangulation because of its struggling, this animal is also unlawful to eat. or by a violent blow .. .* \$> This refers to the animal that is hit with a heavy object until it dies. Ibn ‘Abbas and several others said it is the animal that is hit with a staff until it dies. ‘ Qatadah said, “The people of Jahiliyyah used to strike the animal with sticks and when it died, they would eat it.”¹²¹ It is recorded in the Sahih. that ‘Ali bin Hatim said, “I asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! I use the Mi’rad³¹ for hunting and catch game with it.’ He replied, *•dst xij j*j •—jLil jL_j i -uSo L Ijl qIfthegame is hit by its sharp edge, eat it. But, if it is hit by its broad side, do not eat it, far it has been beaten to death. Therefore, the Prophet jg made a distinction between killing the animal with the sharp edge of an arrow or a hunting stick, and rendered it lawful, and what is killed by the broad side of an object, and rendered it unlawful because it was beaten to death. There is a consensus among the scholars of Fiqh on this subject.* 111 At-Tabari 9:496. 121 At-Tabari 9:496. * A sharp-edged piece of wood or a piece of wood provided with a piece of iron used for hunting. 141 Fath Al-B&ri9:518.

As for the animal that falls headlong from a high place and dies as a result, it is also prohibited. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that an animal that dies by a headlong fall, “Is that which falls from a mountain.”¹¹¹ Qatadah said that it is the animal that falls in a well.*2 * As- Suddi said that it is the animal that falls from a mountain or in a well.¹³¹ As for the animal that dies by being gorged by another animal, it is also prohibited, even if the horn opens a flesh wound and it bleeds to death from its neck. Allah’s statement, *and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal,* } refers to the animal that was attacked by a lion, leopard, tiger, wolf or dog, then the wild beast eats a part of it and it dies because of that. This type is also prohibited, even if the animal bled to death from its neck. There is also a consensus on this ruling. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to eat the sheep, camel, or cow that were partly eaten by a wild animal. Allah prohibited this practice for the believers. Allah’s statement, *unless you are able to slaughter it,* } before it dies, due to the causes mentioned above. This part of the Ayah is connected to, *and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal.* } ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statement. m At-Tabari 9:498. 121 At-Tabari 9:498. Al-Tabari 9:498.

unless you are able to slaughter it, } “Unless you are able to slaughter the animal in the cases mentioned in the Ayah while it is still alive, then eat it, for it was properly slaughtered.”¹¹ ‘ Similar was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and As-Suddi.² Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “If you are able to slaughter the animal that has been hit by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the gorging of horns while it still moves a foot or a leg, then eat from

its meat.”³ Similar was reported from Tawus, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, ‘Ubayd bin ‘Umayr, Ad-Dahhak and several others, that if the animal that is being slaughtered still moves, thus demonstrating that it is still alive while slaughtering, then it is lawful.⁴ The Two Sahihs recorded that Rafi‘ bin Khadij said, “I asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! We fear that we may meet our enemy tomorrow and we have no knives, could we slaughter the animals with reeds?’ The Prophet said, <il jL-l ifjJt I lit *5 jilaJI 1*1^ i pJajO Ul “Vow can use what makes blood flow and you can eat what is slaughtered with the Name of Allah. But do not use teeth or claws (in slaughtering). I will tell you why, as for teeth, they are bones, and claws are used by Ethiopians for slaughtering .t”⁵ Allah said next, C> iand that which is sacrificed on An-Nusub.} Nusub were stone altars that were erected around the Ka’bah, as Mujahid and Ibn Jurayj stated.⁶ Ibn Jurayj said, “There were three hundred and sixty Nusub [around the At-Tabari 9:502. At-Tabari 9:504, 507. ’3| At-Tabari 9:503. ’4| At-Tabari 9 :504 ’ Fath Al-Bari 9 :554 , Muslim 3 : 1558 At-Tabari 9 :508

89 Surah 5. Al-Maidah (3) (Part-6) Ka’bah) that the Arabs used to slaughter in front of, during the time of Jahiliyyah. They used to sprinkle the animals that came to the Ka’bah with the blood of slaughtered animals, whose meat they cut to pieces and placed on the altars.” Allah forbade this practice for the believers. He also forbade them from eating the meat of animals that were slaughtered in the vicinity of the Nuşub, even if Allah’s Name was mentioned on these animals when they were slaughtered, because it is a type of Shirk that Allah and His Messenger si have forbidden. The Prohibition of Using Al-Azlam for Decision Making Allah said, i(Forbidden) also is to make decisions with Al-Azlam} The Ayah commands, “O believers! You are forbidden to use Al-Azlam (arrows) for decision making,” which was a practice of the Arabs during the time of Jahiliyyah. They would use three arrows, one with the word ‘Do’ written on it, another that says ‘Do not’, while the third does not say anything. Some of them would write on the first arrow, ‘My Lord commanded me,’ and, ‘My Lord forbade me,’ on the second arrow and they would not write anything on the third arrow. If the blank arrow was picked, the person would keep trying until the arrow that says do or do not was picked, and the person would implement the command that he picked. Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Azlam were arrows that they used to seek decisions through.*2 * Muhammad bin Ishaq and others said that the major idol of the tribe of Quraysh was Hubal, which was erected on the tip of a well inside the Ka’bah, where gifts were presented and where the treasure of the Ka’bah was kept. There, they also had seven arrows that they would use to seek a decision concerning matters of dispute. Whatever the chosen arrow would tell them, they would abide by it! ’ Al- Bukhari*4 ’ recorded that when the Prophet jg entered Al- m At-Tabari 9 :508 ’ At-Tabari 9:515. ’ At-Tabari 9:513. ’ Fath Al-Bari 6 :446

90 Tafstr Ibtî Kathir Ka’bah (after Makkah was conquered), he found pictures of Ibrahim and Ismail in it holding the Azldm in their hands. The Prophet commented, Ixl Ifi l«.; .aT.. J Ufii IyJs- jLa) <ul "May Allah fight them (the idolaters)! They know that they never used the Azldm to make decisions . Mujahid commented on Allah’s statement. i(Forbidden) also is to make decisions with Al-Azldm “These were arrows that the Arabs used, and dice that the Persians and Romans used in gambling.”¹¹ This statement by Mujahid, that these arrows were used in gambling, is doubtful unless we say that they used the arrows for gambling sometimes and for decisions other times, and Allah knows best. We should also state that Allah mentioned Azlam and gambling in His statement before the end of the Surah (5:90, 91), pi PM& «% 4015 jar gx iii <\$& » ^ ps 4 SO pz& J Oi iO you who believe! Intoxicants (all

kinds of alcoholic drinks), and gambling, and Al-Ansdb, and Al-Azldm are an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful. Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with intoxicants (alcoholic drinks) and gatnbling, and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from the Saldh (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} In this Ayah, Allah said, i(Forbidden) also is to make decisions with Al-Azldm, (all) that is Fisq.b meaning, all these practices constitute disobedience, sin, misguidance, ignorance and, above all, Shirk. m At-Tabari 9:512.

d(j sJr- „„« »-rsis Hir VtpTthey seek. . couectors of Sunan m Ahmad, Al-Bukhari and uThe Prophet SK used to 1",a rd rfiat Jabir bin 'Abdullah smd, t0 guide one to how to make fetdchurah us (hc samhs of rtght action), in aii matters, as »c Qur'an. He sa.d, ,i;, ySi\^ o'^—S J -- w-iJ " :JU j\ - t*/' V>J^ , .-iiu - . . , «»tu aj J djt; J °r-iJ hT- - ' ,. . ; ... A . a o» 4^ * * * * ' . _ *r > cr1. " ..,at Svs: r^ ilf anyone of you thinks and m-> (cr two Rak'ah prayer other tha , Yowr knowledge, the prayer) V .[fjy2 great bounty , for You are from Your ability and I askfa Jo, ^^^ k capable and I am not Youjun f,lis matter (and one the Unseen. O Allah! If You for my religion, should mention the matter or J ; /0r my P^scnj mid my livelihood and the Hereafiero ^ mt. f0 have later needs') then ordam it for » ; kmm> that tins —«- ivith it.' ,l '] , J At-Tirmidhi . r-r,uprted by Ahmad, anu This is the wording collecte 3 58 Abu oawud 2:187, TW Zadhi^t •»- M9i°h ' :440 ‘

Shaytan and the Disbelievers Do Not Will Ever FollowThem ^Tafsir [blatter Hope that Muslim,, Allah said, 4(^4* irt b ooK ,^Jf iThis day, those who disbelieved have given up all hope ofyour religion ; ‘Ali bin Abi Tajhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah means, “They gave up hope that Muslims would revert to their religion.” This is similar to the saying of ‘Ata’ bin Abi Rabah, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan. 121 This meaning is supported by a Hadith recorded in the Sahih that states, « Verily, Slmytdn has given up hope that those who pray in the Arabian Peninsula, ivill worship him. But he will still stir trouble among them .»|3 It is also possible that the Ayah negates the possibility that the disbelievers and Shaytan will ever be like Muslims, since Muslims have various qualities that contradict Shirk and its people. This is why Allah commanded His believing servants to observe patience, to be steadfast in defying and contradicting the disbelievers, and to fear none but Allah. Allah said, iSofear them not, but fear Me meaning, ‘do not fear them when you contradict them. Rather, fear Me and I will give you victory over them, I will eradicate them, and make you prevail over them, I will please your hearts and raise you above them in this life and the Hereafter.’ Islam Has Been Perfected For Muslims Allah said, At-Tabari 9 :5 16 121 At-Tabari 9:516. [31 Muslim 4:2166.

itpfp4*;&&Apip i3i iThis day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed My favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion.} This, indeed, is the biggest favor from Allah to this Ummah, for He has completed their religion for them, and they, thus, do not need any other religion or any other Prophet except Muhammad jfc. This is why Allah made Muhammad jg the Final Prophet and sent him to all humans and Jinn. Therefore, the permissible is what he allows, the impermissible is what he prohibits, the Law is what he legislates and everything that he conveys is true and authentic and does not contain lies or contradictions. Allah said; uJu.pip il%) iAnd the Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice,} meaning, it is true in what it conveys and just in what it commands and forbids. When Allah completed the religion for Muslims, His favor became complete for them as well. Allah said, it,pfp 4*;j&& i&jpip 421 iThis day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed My favor

upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion.} meaning, accept Islam for yourselves, for it is the religion that Allah likes and which He chose for you, and it is that with which He sent the best of the honorable Messengers and the most glorious of His Books. Ibn Jarir recorded that Harun bin 'Antarah said that his father said, "When the Ayah, ip.ip 421 yfii} iThis day, I have perfected your religion for you ...} was revealed, during the great day of Hajj (the Day of 'Arafah, the ninth day of Dhul-Hijjah) TJmar cried. The Prophet jg said, What makes you cry?' He said, What made me cry is that our

religion is being perfected for us. Now it is perfect, nothing is perfect, but it is bound to deteriorate.' The Prophet gg said, «Yom have said the truthy* 1 ' What supports the meaning of this Hadith is the authentic Hadith, iltiP 'IjO* ^ Aslant was strange in its beginning and will return strange once more. Therefore, Tiiba121 for the strangersV31 Imam Ahmad recorded that Tariq bin Shihab said, "A Jewish man said to Umar bin Al-Khattab, 'O Leader of the Believers! There is a verse in your Book, which is read by all of you (Muslims), and had it been revealed to us, we would have taken that day (on which it was revealed) as a day of celebration.' Umar bin Al-Khattab asked, Which is that verse?' The Jew replied, pap iThis day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed Myfavor upon you . . . \$> Umar replied, "By Allah! I know when and where this verse was revealed to Allah's Messenger g;. It was the evening on the Day of 'Arafah on a Friday.'"141 Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith through Al-Hasan bin As-Sabbah from Ja'far bin 'Awn.*5 ' Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal^ also recorded this Hadith. In the narration collected by Al-Bukhari in the book of Tafsir, through Tariq, he said, "The Jews said to Umar, 'By Allah! There is a verse that is read by all of you (Muslims), and had it been revealed to us, we would have taken that day (on which it was revealed) as a day of celebration.' Umar said, At-Tabari 9:519. Tuba means "good news", and it is also a tree in Paradise. See the Tafsir of Surat Ar-Ra'd 13 :29 (volume five) (3] Muslim 1 :130. Ahmad 1 :38. ,S] Path Al-Bari 1:129. Muslim 4:2313, At-Tirmidhi Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:407 and An- Nasat 5 :251

"By Allah! I know when and where this verse was revealed and where the Messenger of Allah was at that time. It was the day of 'Arafah, and I was at 'Arafah, by Allah." ' Sufyan (one of the narrators) doubted if Friday was mentioned in this narration. Sufyan's confusion was either because he was unsure if his teacher included this statement in the Hadth or not. Otherwise, if it was because he doubted that the particular day during the Farewell Hajj was a Friday, it would be a mistake that could not and should not have come from someone like Sufyan Ath-Thawri. The fact that it was a Friday, is agreed on by the scholars of Sirah and Fiqh. There are numerous Hadiths that support this fact that are definitely authentic and of the Mutawati^ type. This Hadith was also reported from TJmar through various chains of narration. PermittingtheDeadAnimals in Conditions ofNecessity Allah said, iBut as for him xvho is forced by severe hunger, with no inclination to sin (such can eat these above mentioned animals), then surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Therefore, when one is forced to take any of the impermissible things that Allah mentioned to meet a necessity, he is allowed and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful with him. Allah is well aware of His servant's needs during dire straits, and He will forgive and pardon His servant in this case. In the Musnad and the Sahth of Ibn Hibban, it is recorded that Ibn TJmar said that Messenger of Allah jg said. M Vjz us utf a 2)1 jj> *Allah likes that His Rukhsah (allowance) be used, just as He dislikes that disobedience to Him is committed .»'3' We should mention here that it is not necessaiy for one to 111 Path Al-Bari 8:119. The name applied to a report

whose every chain of narration contains a number of trustworthy narrators in each level of the chain. Ibn Hibban 4:182.

96 Tafstr Ibn Kathir wait three days before eating the meat of dead animals, as many unlettered Muslims mistakenly think. Rather, one can eat such meat when the dire need arises. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Waqid Al-Laythi said that the Companions asked, “O Messenger of Allah! We live in a land where famine often strikes us. Therefore, when are we allowed to eat the meat of dead animals?” The Prophet s§ replied, i IyisJC 1 j>, lil» “When you neither find food for lunch and dinner nor have any produce to eat, then eat from it.i> Only Imam Ahmad * collected this narration and its chain meets the criteria of the Two Sahihs. Allah said, i with no inclination to sin,\$ meaning, one does not incline to commit what Allah has prohibited. Allah has allowed one when necessity arises to eat from what He otherwise prohibits, under the condition that his heart does not incline to eat what Allah prohibited. Allah said in Surat Al-Baqarah, , yi f* gli jjt i But if one is forced by necessity without willful disobedience nor transgressing due limits, then there is no sin on him. Truly, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful> Some scholars used this Ayah as evidence that those who travel for the purpose of committing an act of disobedience are not allowed to use any of the legal concessions of travel, because these concessions are not earned through sin, and Allah knows best. & Lirffe jy'jii' ty i-iU' j£j Ji jj Tiu y@k^ &&p pz gsst\ \#xhpz i4. They ask you what is lawful for titan. Say: "Lawful unto Ahmad 5:218.

you are At-Tayyibat (the good things). And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds, training and teaching them (to catch) in the manner as directed to you by Allah; so eat of what they catch for you, but pronounce the Name of Allah over it, and have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is swift in reckoning Clarifying the Lawful In the previous Ayah Allah mentioned the prohibited types of food, the impure and unclean things, harmful for those who eat them, either to their bodies, religion or both, except out of necessity, c^ ft U ftS2 i while He has explained to you in detail what is forbidden to you, except under compulsion of necessity After that, Allah said, ft jJ j» p. jJ Tili i Theu ask you what is lawful for them. Say, "Lawful unto you are At-Tayyibat. In Surat Al-A'rdf Allah describes Muhammad jag allowing the good things and prohibiting the filthy things. Muqatil said, “At-Tayyibat includes everything Muslims are allowed and the various types of legally earned provision.” Az-Zuhri was once asked about drinking urine for medicinal purposes and he said that it is not a type of Tayyibat.” Ibn Abi Hatim also narrated this statement. Using Jawarih^1^ to Hunt Game is Permissible Allah said, \$And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds ...\$ That is, lawful for you are the animals slaughtered in Allah’s Name, and the good things for sustenance. [The game you m Hunting animal

catch) with the Jawarih are also lawful for you. This refers to trained dogs and falcons, as is the opinion of the majority of the Companions, their followers, and the Imams. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, <c*P ik 4And those Jawarih (beasts and birds of prey) which you have trained as hounds... refers to trained hunting dogs, falcons and all types of birds and beasts that are trained to hunt, including dogs, wild cats, falcons, and so forthJ ' Ibn Abi Hatim collected this and said, “Similar was reported from Khaythamah, Tawus, Mujahid, Makhul and Yahya bin Abi Kathir.”*2 ' Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn TJmar said, “You are permitted the animal that the trained birds, such as falcons, hunt for you if you catch it (before it eats from it). Otherwise, do not eat from it.”13 ' I say, the majority of scholars say

that hunting with trained birds is just like hunting with trained dogs, because bird's of prey catch the game with their claws, just like dogs. Therefore, there is no difference between the two. Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Adi bin Hatim said that he asked the Messenger of Allah ﷺ about the game that the falcon hunts and the Messenger ﷺ said, «جاءك شيء فاقطع له»⁴¹ These carnivores that are trained to catch game are called Jawarih in Arabic, a word that is derived from Jarh, meaning, what one earns. The Arabs would say, "So-and-so has Jaraha something good for his family," meaning, he has earned them something good. The Arabs would say, "So-and-so does not have a Jarih for him," meaning, a caretaker. Allah also said, «وإنه يعلم ما تعملون»⁴² And He knows what you have done during the day. At-Jabari 9 :548 At-Jabari 9:547-548. At-Tabari 9 :549 141 At-Tabari 9:550.

meaning, the good or evil you have Allah's statement, earned or committed. (trained as hounds,) those Jawarih that have been trained to hunt as hounds with their claws or talons. Therefore, if the game is killed by the weight of its blow, not with its claws, then we are not allowed to eat from the game. Allah said, «وإنه يعلم ما تعملون»⁴³ training than in the manner as directed to you by Allah,) as when the beast is sent, it goes after the game, and when it catches it, it keeps it until its owner arrives and does not catch it to eat it itself. This is why Allah said here, «وإنه يعلم ما تعملون»⁴⁴ When the beast is trained, and it catches the game for its owner who mentioned Allah's Name when he sent the beast after the game, then this game is allowed according to the consensus of scholars, even if it was killed. There are Hadiths in the Sunnah that support this statement. The Two Sahihs recorded that 'Adi bin Hatim said, "I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! I send hunting dogs and mention Allah's Name.' He replied, «نعم»⁴⁵ 1) «نعم»⁴⁶ with mentioning Allah's Name, you let loose your tamed dog after a game and it catches it, you may eat what it catches.» I said, 'Even if it kills the game?' He replied, «نعم»⁴⁷ "p 'Ps l}* P vLk 14^—i ^ 'ip o!j 'J "Even if it kills the game, unless another dog joins the hunt, for you mentioned Allah's Name when sending your dog, but not the other dog.» I said, 'I also use the Mi'rad and catch game with it.' He replied,

«dsfc "Ai jjj Lj \ jlj b <lSo (_jjo O—j IjJ aIf the game is hit by its sharp edge, eat it, but if it is hit by its broad side, do not eat it, for it has been beaten to death. In smother narration, the Prophet ﷺ said, «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁴⁸ bid* Nii i>ii tJii /iii id* c-Ljt ip« «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁴⁹ you send your hunting dog, then mention Allah's Name and whatever it catches for you and you find alive, slaughter it. If you catch the game dead and the dog did not eat from it, then eat from it, for the dog has caused its slaughter to be fulfilled.⁵⁰ In yet another narration of two Sahths, the Prophet ﷺ said, «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵¹ tlf the dog eats from the game, do not eat from it for Ifear that it has caught it as prey for itself⁵² V31 Mention Allah's Name Upon Sending the Predators to Catch the Game Allah said, «وإنه يعلم ما تعملون»⁵³ meaning, upon sending it. The Prophet ﷺ said to 'Adi bin Hatim, «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵⁴ «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵⁵ *When you send your trained dog and mention Allah's Name, eat from what it catches for you.⁵⁶ 141 It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Thalabah related Fath Al-Bari 9 :527 , Muslim 3 : 1529 121 Path Al-Bari 9:513, Muslim 3 :1530 131 Path Al-Bari 9:527 , MusUm 3 :1529 141 FathAl-Bari 9 :524

that the Prophet ﷺ said, «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵⁷ jlj jSjU i c4*j lilj ijil ji--l jS'jU cJlijl Ijl "If you send your hunting dog, mention Allah's Name over it. If you shoot an arrow, mention Allah's Name over it.» 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented, «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵⁸ «إذا أرسلت كلبك يطير فاقطع له»⁵⁹ "When

you send a beast of prey, say, 'In the Name of Allah!' If you forget, then there is no harm."¹² ' It was also reported that this Ayah commands mentioning Allah's Name upon eating. It is recorded in the Two Sahls that the Messenger of Allah jg taught his stepson TJmar bin Abu Salamah saying, "in; iL Jsj jsj 5ii «Mention Allah's Name, eat with your right hand and eat from the part of the plate that is in front of you. »*³ Al-Bukhari recorded that 'A'ishah said, "They asked, 'O Allah's Messenger! Some people, - recently converted from disbelief - bring us some meats that we do not know if Allah's Name was mentioned over or not.' He replied, Oi «Mention Allah's Name on it and eat from it if a"¹⁴¹ «³⁶ 3 3p pas Utp j*1 Z til 0 Oi && U bi 4 /&* JL»- oii yp 'ij 45. Made lawful to you this day are At-Tayyibdt. The food of the People of the Scripture is lawful to you, and your food is lawful to them. (Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women (2) 13) HI Fath.Al-Bari⁹ :527 , Muslim 3 :1532 At-Tabari 9 :571 FathAl-Bari⁹ :43 1 , Muslim 3 : 1599 FathAl-Bari⁹ :550.

from the believers and chaste women from those who were given the Scripture before your time when you have given them their due, desiring chastity, not illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as girlfriends (or lovers). And whosoever rejects faith, then fruitless is his work; and in the Hereafter he will be among the losers Permitting the Slaughtered Animals of the People of the Book After Allah mentioned the filthy things that He prohibited for His believing servants and the good things that He allowed for them, He said next, 'fi iMade lawful to you this day are At-Tayyibat .> Allah then mentioned the ruling concerning the slaughtered animals of the People of the Book, the Jews and Christians, Jr Z/& f \$The food of the People of the Scripture is lawful to you..)? meaning, their slaughtered animals, as Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Umamah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata', Al-Hasan, Makhul, Ibrahim An-Nakha'I, As-Suddi and Muqatil bin Hayyan stated.¹¹ ' This ruling, that the slaughtered animals of the People of the Book are permissible for Muslims, is agreed on by the scholars, because the People of the Book believe that slaughtering for other than Allah is prohibited. They mention Allah's Name upon slaughtering their animals, even though they have deviant beliefs about Allah that do not befit His majesty. It is recorded in the Sahth. that 'Abdullah bin Mughaffal said, "While we were attacking the fort of Khaybar, a person threw a leather bag containing fat, and I ran to take it and said, I will not give anyone anything from this container today.' But when I turned I saw the Prophet \$gg (standing behind) while smiling."² ' The scholars rely on this Hadlth as evidence that we are allowed to eat what we need of foods from the booty 111 At-Tabari 9:573-577. 121 FathAl-Bari 9:552.

103 Surah 5. Al-Md'idah (5) (Part-6 before it is divided. The scholars of the Hanafi, the Shafil and the Hanbali Madhhabs rely on this Hadith to allow eating parts of the slaughtered animals of the Jews that they prohibit for themselves, such as the fat. They used this Hadith as evidence against the scholars of the Maliki Madhhab who disagreed with this ruling. A better proof is the Hadith recorded in the Sahth that the people of Khaybar gave the Prophet jg a gift of a roasted leg of sheep, which they poisoned. The Prophet jg used to like eating the leg of the sheep and he took a bite from it, but it told the Prophet jg that it was poisoned, so he discarded that bite. The bite that the Prophet jg took effected the palate of his mouth, while Bishr bin Al-Bara' bin Ma'rur died from eating from that sheep. The Prophet jg had the Jewish woman, Zaynab, who poisoned the sheep, killed. Therefore, the Prophet jg and his Companions wanted to eat from that sheep and did not ask the Jews if they removed what the Jews believed was prohibited for them, such as its fat. 111 Allah's statement, J*pas iand your food is lawful

to them.} means, you are allowed to feed them from your slaughtered animals. Therefore, this part of the Ayah is not to inform the People of the Scriptures that they are allowed to eat our food - unless we consider it information for us about the ruling that they have - i.e, that they are allowed all types of foods over which Allah's Name was mentioned, whether slaughtered according to their religion or otherwise. The first explanation is more plausible. So it means: you are allowed to feed them from your slaughtered animals just as you are allowed to eat from theirs, as equal compensation and fair treatment. The Prophet ﷺ gave his robe to 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salfil, who was wrapped with it when he died. They say that he did that because 'Abdullah had given his robe to Al-'Abbas when Al-'Abbas came to Al-Madinah. As for the Hadith, Vi iuu Jst; v; , vi "Do not befriend but a believer, nor should other than a Taqi 111 Path Al-Bari 7 :569

(pious person) eat your food. II] This is to encourage such behavior, and Allah knows best. The Permission to Marry Chaste Women From the People of the Scriptures Allah said, 4(Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from the believers^ The Ayah states: you are allowed to marry free, chaste believing women. This Ayah is talking about women who do not commit fornication, as evident by the word 'chaste'. Allah said in another Ayah, O'itii Vj Jf. 4Desiring chastity not committing illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as boyfriends (lovers). [4:25] 'Abdullah Ibn 'Umar used to advise against marrying Christian women saying, "I do not know of a worse case of Shirk than her saying that Isa is her lord, while Allah said, 4And do not marry idolatresses till they believe.4" Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Malik Al-Ghifari said that Ibn 'Abbas said that when this Ayah was revealed, 4U& ^ 4And do not marry idolatresses till they believe,> the people did not marry the pagan women. When the following Ayah was revealed. 4f& « .20 u laity 4(LaivJul to you in marriage) are chaste women from the believers and chaste women from those who were given the Scripture before your time)? IM Abu Dawud 5 : 167 . 'Abdullah bin Ubayy was known as a hypocrite

they married women from the People of the Book." Some of the Companions married Christian women and did not see any problem in this, relying on the honorable Ayah, 4(Lawful to you in marriage) are chaste women from those who were given the Scripture before your time} Therefore, they made this Ayah an exception to the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, 4U:& 4And do not marry the idolatresses till they believe, considering the latter Ayah to include the People of the Book in its general meaning. Otherwise, there is no contradiction here, since the People of the Book were mentioned alone when mentioning the rest of the idolators. Allah said, iThose who disbelieve from among the People of the Scripture and the idolators, were not going to leave (their disbelief) until there came to them clear evidence. and, jJu Jci'S \yj\ yjj 4And say to those who were given the Scripture and to those who are illiterates: "Do you (also) submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided.} Allah said next, 4When you have given them their due}. This refers to the Mahr, so just as these women are chaste and honorable, then give them their Mahr with a good heart. We should mention here that Jabir bin 'Abdullah, 'Amir Ash-Shalji, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and Al-Hasan Al-Basri stated that when a man marries a woman and she commits illegal sexual intercourse before the marriage is consummated, the marriage is annulled. In this case, she gives back the Mahr that he paid

Jt mm \.a ijLSii\§&\ dtM ^ her. Allah said, JdSAj 1 <l\pP _> Uljs Pf&ip, yu>.^c-jl&*£» to*jpy ijUll[k^f vT" •*,**> " mv X> O^^to4 j** Jdat-f iDesiring chastity, not illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them

as girl- friends (or lovers).} And just as women must be chaste and avoid illegal sexual activity, such is the case with men, who must also be chaste and honorable Therefore, Allah said, j&} 4...not illegal sexual intercourse'} as adulterous people do, those who do not avoid sin, nor reject adultery with whomever offers it to them. tSJicl %} 4nor taking them as girl-friends (or lovers),} meaning those who have mistresses and girlfriends who commit illegal sexual intercourse with them, as we mentioned in the explanation of Surat An-Nisa'. *P~ a P.&p& lA^s j* >h dS onto dpTci) -£33f at p;:A \±&r3 ii*i !£3 it fj!4 pi&Mpu it £ £; 53 it it it t^b gi-* - l>i jt>J iif i_>_^ U Uj J^ojjtj IjidlG tli m At-Tabari 9 :585-586.

> > i6. O you who believe! When you stand (intend) to offer the Saldh (the prayer), then wash your faces and your hands (fbreartns) up to the elbows, rub (by passing wet hands over) your heads, and (wash) yourfeet up to the ankles. Ifyou are in a state of janaba, purify yourselves (bathe your whole body). But ifyou are ill or on a journey or any ofyou comesfrom the Ghd'it (toilet) or you have touched women and you find no water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth and rub therewith your faces and hands. Allah does not want to place you in difficulty, but He wants to purify you, and to complete His Favor to you that you may be thankful.} The Order to PerformWudu' Allah said, Si^ iWhen you standfor (intend to offer) the Saldh,} Allah commanded performing Wudu' for the prayer. This is a command of obligation in the case of impurity, and in the case of purity, it is merely a recommendation. It was said that in

the beginning of Islam, Muslims had to perform Wudu' for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1429–1446]

every prayer, but later on, this ruling was abrogated. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Sulayman bin Buraydah said that his father said, “The Prophet jg used to perform Wudu' before every prayer. On the Day of Victory, he performed Wudu' and wiped on his Khuffs and prayed the five prayers with one Wudu'. Umar said to him, ‘O Messenger of Allah! You did something new that you never did before.’The Prophet said, Ij «djO lJUP ® a 'I did that intentionally O 'Umarh '''* 11 Muslim¹²¹ and the collectors of the Sunan also recorded this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said,“Hasan Sahih.”^{13]} 111 Ahmad 5:358. ¹²¹ Muslim 1 :232. Abu Dawud 1 :120, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1 :194, An-Nasal 1 :86, Ibn Majah 1 :170.

208 Tafcir Ibn Kathfr Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Fadl bin Al-Mubashshir said, “I saw Jabir bin ‘Abdullah perform several prayers with only one Wudu'. When he would answer the call of nature, he performed Wudu' and wiped the top of his Khuffs with his wet hand. I said, ‘O Abu ‘Abdullah! Do you do this according to your own opinion?’ He said, ‘Rather, I saw the Prophet §j§ do the same thing. So, I do what I saw the Messenger of Allah jg doing.’”¹¹¹ Ibn Majah also recorded this Hadith}2^ Ahmad recorded that Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah bin Umar was asked; “Did you see ‘Abdullah bin Umar perform Wudu' for every prayer, whether he was in a state of purity or not,?” So he replied, “Asma' bint Zayd bin Al-Khattab told him that ‘Abdullah bin Hanzalah bin Abi ‘Amir Al-Ghasll told her that the Messenger of Allah jgg was earlier commanded to perform Wudu' for every prayer, whether he needed it or not. When that became hard on him, he was commanded to use Siwak for every prayer, and to perform Wudu' when Hadath (impurity) occurs. ‘Abdullah (Ibn Umar) thought that he was able to do that (perform Wudu' for every prayer) and he kept doing that until he died.”¹³¹ Abu Dawud¹⁴¹ also

collected this narration. This practice by Ibn Umar demonstrates that it is encouraged, not obligatory, to perform Wudu' for every prayer, and this is also the opinion of the majority of scholars. Abu Dawud recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said that when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ once left the area where he answered the call of nature, he was brought something to eat. They said, "Should we bring you your water for Wudu'?" He said, "Yes."¹⁰⁴ He was commanded to perform Wudu' when I stand up for prayer. »¹⁵¹ At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasab⁶¹ also recorded this Hadith and At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan." Muslim recorded¹¹¹ At-Tabari 10:11. ¹²¹ Ibn Majah 1 :170. Ahmad 5:225. ¹⁴¹ Abu Dawud 1:41. ¹⁵¹ Abu Dawud 4 :36 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :579 and An-Nasab 1 :85

¹⁰⁹ Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (6) (Part-6) that Ibn 'Abbas said, "We were with the Prophet ﷺ when he went to answer the call of nature and when he came back, he was brought some food. He was asked, 'O Messenger of Allah! Do you want to perform Wudu'?' He said, 'Yes, I am about to pray so that I have to make Wudu'y'" [11 The Intention and Mentioning Allah's Name for Wudu Allah said; then wash your faces...} The obligation for the intention before Wudu' is proven by this Ayah; i.e. when you stand (intend) to offer the Salah then wash your faces...} This is because it is just like the Arabs saying; "When you see the leader, then stand." Meaning stand for him. And the Two Sahih's recorded the Hadith, «Actions are judged by their intentions, and each person will earn what he intended»¹²¹ It is also recommended before washing the face that one mentions Allah's Name for the Wudu'. A Hadith that was narrated by several Companions states that the Prophet ﷺ said, «There is no Wudu' for he who does not mention Allah's Name over it.»¹³ Muslim 1 :283 ¹²¹ Fath Al-Bari 1:15, Muslim 3 :1515 ¹³¹ Abu Dawud 1 :75.

¹¹⁰ Tafsir Ibn Kathir It is also recommended that one washes his hands before he puts his hands in the vessel of water, especially after one wakes up from sleep, for the Two Sahih's recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "When one of you wakes up from his sleep, let him not put his hand in the pot until he washes it thrice, for one of you does not know where his hand spent the night." [1 ' The face according to the scholars of Fiqh starts where the hair line on the head starts, regardless of one's lack or abundance of hair, until the end of the cheeks and chin, and from ear to ear. Passing the Finger through the Beard While Performing Wudu' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Wa'il said, "I saw the Messenger of Allah ﷺ when he was performing Wudu'... When he washed his face, he passed his fingers through his beard three times. He said, 'I saw the Messenger of Allah do what you saw me doing.'"² At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah also recorded this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said "Hasan Sahih." while Al-Bukhari graded it Hasan. How to Perform Wudu' Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas once performed Wudu' and took a handful of water and rinsed his mouth and nose with it. He took another handful of water and joined both hands and washed his face. He took another handful of water and washed his right hand, and another handful and washed his left hand with it. He next wiped his head. Next, he took a handful of water and sprinkled it on his right foot and washed it and took another handful of water and washed his left foot. When he finished, he said, "This is how I saw the Messenger of Allah (performing Wudu)."¹⁴ Al-Bukhari also recorded *** Fath Al-Bari 1 :316, Muslim 1 :233. * Jami' Al-Masanid was-Sunan 17 :197. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 1 :133 and Ibn Majah 1 :148. Ahmad 1 :268

it. Allah said, *Wudu' ila* and your hands (forearms) up to (ila) the elbows...} meaning, including the elbows. Allah said in another Ayah [using *ila*], *Wudu' ila* of % %} , 4And devour not their substance to (ila) your substance (by adding or including it in your property) . Surely, this is a great sin.} It is recommended that those who perform Wudu' should wash a part of the upper arm with the elbow. Al-Bukhari and ' Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *Wudu' ila* jgg "On the Day of Resurrection, my Ummah will be called "those with the radiant appendages" because of the traces of Wudu'. Therefore, whoever can increase the area of his radiance should do so.» Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "I heard my intimate friend (the Messenger) saying, "The radiance of the believer reaches the areas that the water of (his) Wudu' reaches.»^ Allah said next, 4Rub your heads.} It is recorded in the Two Sahths that Malik bin 'Amr bin Yahya Al-Mazini said that his father said that a man said to 'Abdullah bin Zayd bin 'Asim, the grandfather of 'Amr bin Yahya and one of the Companions of the Messenger jg, "Can you show me how the Messenger of Allah used to perform m FathAl-Bari 1 :290. ,21 FathAl-Bari 1 :283, Muslim 1 :216. Muslim 1 :219.

Wudu'?" 'Abdullah bin Zayd said, "Yes." He then asked for a pot of water. He poured from it on his hands and washed them twice, then he rinsed his mouth and washed his nose [with water] thrice [by putting water in it and blowing it out]. He washed his face thrice and after that he washed his forearms up to the elbows twice. He then passed his wet hands over his head from its front to its back and vice versa, beginning from the front and taking them to the back of his head up to the nape of the neck and then brought them to the front again from where he had started. He next washed his feet. * A similar description of the Wudu' of the Messenger of Allah was performed by 'Ali in the Hadith by 'Abdu Khayr.*2 * Abu Dawud recorded that Mu'awiyah and Al-Miqdad bin Ma'dikarib narrated similar descriptions of the Wudu' of the Messenger of Allah jg. * These Hadiths indicate that it is necessary to wipe the entire head. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Humran bin Aban said, "I saw Uthman bin 'Affan performing Wudu', and he poured water over his hands and washed them thrice, and then rinsed his mouth and washed his nose [by putting water in it, and then blowing it out]. Then he washed his face thrice, and then his right forearm up to the elbows thrice, and washed the left forearm thrice. Then he passed his wet hands over his head, then he washed his right foot thrice, and next his left foot thrice. After that TJthman said, I saw the Prophet jg performing Wudu' like this, and said, 0If anyone performs Wudu' like that of mine and offers a two- Rak'ah prayer during which he does not think of anything else then his past sins will be forgiven .»""*41 Al-Bukhari*5 * and Muslim*6 ' also recorded this Hadith in the * 1 * Fath Al-B&ri 1 :347, Muslim 1 :210. * Abu Dawud 1 :82 * Abu Dfiwud 1 : 88-89 Abdur Razzaq 1 :44 * FathAl-Bari 1 :311. * Muslim 1 :205.

Two Sahihs. In his Sunan, Abu Dawud also recorded it from TJthman, under the description of Wudu', and in it, that he wiped his head one time. The Necessity of Washing the Feet Allah said, *Wudu' ila* your feet up to ankles.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas stated that the Ayah refers to washing (the feet). 12 'Abdullah bin Mas*ud, TJrwah, 'Ata', 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Mujahid, Ibrahim, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Az-Zuhri and Ibrahim At-Taymi said similarly. 131 This clearly indicates the necessity of washing the feet, just as the Salaf have said, and not only wiping over the top of the bare foot. The Hadiths that Indicate the Necessity of Washing the Feet We mentioned the Hadiths by the two Leaders of the Faithful, 'Uthman and 'Ali, and also by Ibn 'Abbas, Mu'awiyah, 'Abdullah bin Zayd bin 'Asim and Al-Miqdad bin Ma'dikarib, that the Messenger of Allah jgg washed his feet for Wudu', either

once, twice or thrice. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said, “The Messenger of Allah jg was once late during a trip we were taking, and he caught up with us when the time remaining for the ‘Asr prayer was short. We were still performing Wudu’ (in a rush) and we were wiping our feet. He shouted at the top of his voice, «Perform Wudu’ thoroughly. Save your heels from the Fire,i”141 The same narration was also collected in the Two Sahihs Abu Dawud 1:80,82. 121 At-Tabari 10:55. At-Tabari 10:54-57. Fath Al-Bari 1 :319, Muslim 1 :214.

from Abu Hurayrah.'11 Muslim recorded that ‘A’ishah said that

the Prophet said, ilrf Ji-J “Perform Wudii' thoroughly. Save your heelsfrom the FireM21 ‘Abdullah bin Al-Harith bin Jaz’ said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jfi saying, ‘jtJl v-jUpSU Jj Save your heels and the bottom of thefeetfrom the FireJ It was recorded by Al-Bayhaqi and Al-Hakim, and this chain is Sahih.[3l Muslim recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said that a man once performed Wudu’ and left a dry spot the size of a fingernail on his foot. The Prophet saw that and he said to him, “Go back and perform proper Wudu' .»*4' Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi also recorded that Anas bin Malik said that a main came to the Prophet \$\$, after he performed Wudu’ and left a dry spot the size of a fingernail on his foot. The Messenger ofAllah said to him, “d «Go back and perform proper Wudu' . »151 Imam Ahmad recorded that some of the wives of the Prophet 5i§ said that the Prophet saw Si a man praying, but noticed a dry spot on his foot, the size of a Dirham. The Messenger of Allah Si ordered that man to perform Wudu’ again.^ This Hadith was also collected by Abu Dawud from Baqiyyah, who added in his narration, “And (the Prophet Fath Al-Bari 1 :321 , Muslim 1 :215. t2 * Muslim 1 :213. 131 Al-Bayhaqi 1 :70 and Al-Hakim in Al-Mustadrak 1 :162. 141 Muslim 1 :215. 151 Al-Bayhaqi 1 :70. 161 Ahmad 3:424.

ordered him) to repeat the prayer.”1 11 This Hadith has a strong, reasonably good chain of narrators. Allah knows best. The Necessity ofWashing Between the Fingers In the Hadith that Humran narrated, ‘Uthman washed between his fingers when he was describing the Wudu’ of the Prophet sg.' ' The collectors of the Sunan recorded that Laqlt bin Sabrah said, “I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Tell me about Wudu’.’The Messenger% replied, «Perform Wudu' thoroughly, wash betweetx the fingers and exaggerate in rinsing your nose, unless you arefastingy^ Wiping Over the Khuffs' ' is an Established Sunnah Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Aws bin Abi Aws said, “I saw the Messenger of Allah perform Wudu’and wipe over his Khuffs. He then stood up for prayer.”15 ' Abu Dawud recorded this Hadith by Aws bin Abi Aws, who said in this narration, “I saw the Messenger of Allah jg, after he answered the call of nature, perform Wudu’ and wipe over his Khuffs and feet.”161 Imam Ahmad recorded that Jarir bin ‘Abdullah Al-Bajali said, “I embraced Islam after Surat Al-Ma’idah was revealed and I saw the Messenger of Allah wipe after I became Muslim.”17 ' It is recorded in the Two Sahths that Hammam said, “Jarir answered the call of nature and then performed Wudu’ and wiped over his Khuffs. He was asked, “Do you do this?’ He said, Yes. I saw the Messenger of Allah jg, after he answered the call of nature, perform Wudu’ and wipe on his Khuffs.”” Al-A‘mash commented that Ibrahim said, “They liked 111 Abu Dawud 1 :12 1 ' Majma'Az-Zawa'id 1 :235. Abu Dawud 1:99, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1:149, An-Nasal 1:79, Ibn Majah 1 :142. ' Leather socks Ahmad 4 :8 Abu Dawud 1:113. 171 Ahmad 4 :363

this Hadith because Jarir embraced Islam after Surat Al-Maidah was revealed.”¹¹¹ This is the wording collected by Muslim. The subject of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ wiping over his Khuffs, instead of washing the feet, if he had worn his Khuffs while having Wudu’, reaches the Mutawatir grade of narration, and they describe this practice by his words and actions. Performing Tayammum with Clean earth When There is no Water and When One is Ill 111 Allah said, *وإذا كنت في السفر أو كنت في مرضك أو كنت في غير ذلك فأوجد من الماء فامسح به باليدين* - ill if you are ill or on a journey or any of you comes from the Ghatt (toilet), or you have touched womenTM and you find no water, then perform Tayammum with clean earth and rub therewith your faces and hands.} We discussed all of this in Surat An-Nisa’, and thus we do not need to repeat it here. We also mentioned the reason behind revealing this Ayah. Yet, Al-Bukhari mentioned an honorable Hadith here specifically about the Tafsir of this noble Ayah. He recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “Upon returning to Al-Madinah, a necklace of mine was broken (and lost) in Al-Bayda’ area. Allah’s Messenger ﷺ stayed there and went to sleep with his head on my lap. Abu Bakr (‘A’ishah’s father) came and hit me on my flank with his hand saying. You have detained the people because of a necklace?’ So I wished I were dead because (I could not move) the Messenger was ﷺ sleeping on my lap and because of the pain Abu Bakr caused me. Allah’s Messenger ﷺ got up when dawn broke and there was no water. So Allah revealed, / 11 » A * •! , , /J V 40 you who believe! When you stand (intend) to offer As-Salath (the prayer), then wash your faces} Fath Al-Bari 1 :589, Muslim 1 :228. See Surat An-Nisa’, no.43 for an explanation of touched women’

until the end of the Ayah. Usayd bin Al-Hudayr said, ‘O the family of Abu Bakr! Allah has blessed the people because of you. Therefore, you are only a blessing for the people.’”^{*} Allah said, *وإن الله لا يريد أن يضعكم في ضيق* Allah does not want to place you in difficulty,} This is why He made things easy and lenient for you. This is why He allowed you to use Tayammum when you are ill and when you do not find water, to make things comfortable for you and as mercy for you. Allah made Tayammum in place of Wudu’, and Allah made it the same as ablution with water for the one who it is legitimate for, except for certain things, as we mentioned before. For example; Tayammum only involves one strike with the hand on the sand and wiping the face and hands. Allah said, *وإن الله لا يريد أن يضعكم في ضيق* but He wants to purify you, and to complete His favor on you that you may be thankful.} for His bounties on you, such as His easy, kind, merciful, comfortable and lenient legislation. Supplicating to Allah after Wudu The Sunnah encourages supplicating to Allah after Wudu’ and states that those who do so are among those who seek to purify themselves, as the Ayah above states. Imam Ahmad, Muslim and the collectors of Sunan narrated that Tjubah bin ‘Amir said, “We were on watch, guarding camels, and when my turn to guard came, I took the camels back at night. I found that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was giving a speech to the people. I heard these words from that speech: *وأي مسلم إذا قام فليصلي ركعتين* Any Muslim who performs Wudu’ properly, then stands up and prays a two Rak’ah prayer with full attention in his heart ^{**} Fath Al-Bari 8:121.

and face, will earn Paradise .» I said. What a good statement this is!’ A person who was close by said, The statement he said before it is even better.’ When I looked, I found that it was Umar, who said, I saw that you just came. The Prophet said, *وأي مسلم إذا قام فليصلي ركعتين* bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger’, the eight doors of Paradise will be

opened for him so that he can enter from any door he wishes . This is the wording collected by Muslim.
12

The Virtue of Wild*’ Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, M iy**1- Ji if/* ‘4=33 jf AliJt 1*1® j* *4 It W M £ jf .uil £ l£Jl fS I.UJl Jot yif\ jl jUJl £« oljb yt liij J** j>A j! »UJl »4>-j l iWhen the Muslim or the believing servant performs Wudu' and washes his face, every sin that he looked at with his eyes will depart from his face with the water, or with the last drop of water. When he washes his Iwnds, every sin that his hands committed will depart from his hands with the water, or with tire last drop of water. When he washes his fret, every sin to which his fret took him will depart with the water, or with the last drop of water. Until, he ends up sinless. Muslim also recorded it. *** According to An-Nawawi; “Submission of the limbs and humility of the heart.” ’ Ahmad 4:153, Muslim: 1:209, Abu Dawud 1:118, An-Nasal 1 :92, Ibn Majah 1 :159. 3| Al-Muwatta’ 1 :32 * Muslim 1 :215

Muslim recorded that Abu Malik Al- Ash'ari said that the Messenger of Allah \$\$ said, ijLL/ijl 'jLl JJ « L)U u Sui 'fs\ 4i ij jii oUJi} fjiJO j5 oJ-^aJ Ij v i\--a j j * <U>- . f * - 4 > . > # ^ , jl wJU ^Purity is half of faith and Al-Hamdu Lillah (all the thanks are due to Allah) fills the Mizdn (the Scale). And Subhdn Allah and Allahu Akbar (all praise is due to Allah, and Allah is the Most Great) fills what is between the heaven and earth. As-Sawm (the fast) is a Junnah (a shield), Sabr (patience) is a light, Sadaqah (charity) is evidence (offaith) and the Qur'an is proof for, or against you. Every person goes out in the morning and ends up selling hitnself, he either frees his soul or destroys Muslim recorded that Ibn TJmar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, * 'tj Ift Jill Jisi *Allah does not accept charity from one who commits Ghulul,121 or prayer without purity.» 111 Muslim 1:203. I2 * Ghulul means to behave treacherously. Here it is about stealing from the goods taken during war. * Muslim1:204.

Wj p& ^ ill, A !yj' £' Qk 'yfi/xlil v'i JLE At Sj. 'At 'At !£% &Sij AXt A tjUl ij*2\$&£ tel fifyz% te4\ v*Aj (A o^i!i ljLr£j !£••• ^it At ilj. ^X. At Xj. #4 ^^ ^5 ^ £& -*~*i*t ^Sol[tjJi—jj jl lj5^ (*^==Cle. jit Hu i^fit !£•* -X/Jt 4 At j*j iit tjijtJ <7. A>u/ remember Allah's favor to you and His covenant with which He bound you when you said: "We hear and we obey." And have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is All-Knower of that which is in the breasts .} <8. O you who believe! Stand out firmly for Allah as just witnesses ; and let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice. Be just, that is nearer to Taqwa; and have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do i9. Allah has promised those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, that for them there is forgiveness and a great reward (i.e. Paradise).} 110. And they who disbelieve and deny Our Ayat are those who will be the dwellers of the Hell-fire.) 111. O you who believe! Remember the favor of Allah unto you xohen some people desired (made a plan) to stretch out their hands against you, but (Allah) held back their hands from you. So have Taqwa of Allah. And in Alldlt let the believers put their trust.} Reminding the Believers of the Bounty of the Message and Islam Allah reminds His believing servants of His bounty by legislating this glorious religion and sending them this honorable Messenger. He also reminds them of the covenant and pledges that He took from them to follow the Messenger support and aid him, implement his Law and convey it on his behalf, while accepting it themselves. Allah said.

4And remember Allah's favor upon you and His covenant with which He bound you when you said, “We hear and we obey This is the pledge that they used to give to the Messenger of Allah when they

embraced Islam. They used to say, “We gave our pledge of obedience to the Messenger of Allah jf to hear and obey, in times when we are active and otherwise, even if we were passed on for rights, and not to dispute leadership with its rightful people.” Allah also said, & !* & X V4 v # 4 And what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! Wt the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord; and He has indeed taken your covenant, if you are real believers.} It was also said that this Ayah (5:7) reminds the Jews of the pledges and promises Allah took from them to follow Muhammad sg and adhere to his Law, as ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas stated. Allah then said, 4’ii i 4 And have Taqiva of Allah.} in all times and situations. Allah says that He knows the secrets and thoughts that the hearts conceal, ijuid ££ if 5^ 4 Verily, Allah is All-Knower of the secrets of (your) breasts.} The Necessity of Observing Justice Allah said, 4A !£* 40 you who believe! Stand out firmly for Allah...} meaning, in truth for the sake of Allah, not for the sake of people or for fame,

4^5 /wsf witnesses} observing justice and not transgression. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that An-Nu'man bin Bashir said, “My father gave me a gift, but ‘Amrah bint Rawahah, my mother, said that she would not agree to it unless he made Allah’s Messenger^ as a witness to it. So, my father went to Allah’s Messenger jg to ask him to be a witness to his giving me the gift. Allah’s Messenger sg asked, oJU; dJj jsU «Have you given the like of it to everyone of your offspring?» He replied in the negative. Allah’s Messenger jg said, ijJlc-Ij iui i’au vHave Taqwd of Allah and treat your children equally. » And said; 'Syr 'Ji -4-ii V J| </ shall not be witness to injustice.» My father then returned and took back his gift.” Allah said; 4Lta-“ jjc oi&CS “^j} iand let not the enmity and hatred of others make you avoid justice.} The Ayah commands: Do not be carried away by your hatred for some people to avoid observing justice with them. Rather, be just with every one, whether a friend or an enemy. This is why Allah said, iBe just: tlmt is nearer to Taqwd} this is better than if you abandon justice in this case. Although Allah said that observing justice is ‘nearer to Taqwa’, there is not any other course of action to take, therefore ‘nearer’ here means *is’. Allah said in another Ayah, Fath Al-Bari 5 :250 , Muslim 3 : 1242

2} iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairer of places for repose .i Some of the female Companions said to “Umar, “You are more rough and crude than the Messenger of Allah jg,” meaning, you are rough, not that the Prophet jg is rough at all. Allah said next, 'if Si 'if !#(>) iand have Taqiva of Allah. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.\$ and consequently, He will reward or punish you according to your actions, whether good or evil. Hence Allah’s statement afterwards, iAllah has promised those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, that for them there is forgiveness£> for their sins, iand a great reward which is Paradise, that is part of Allah’s mercy for His servants. They will not earn Paradise on account of their good actions, but rather on account of His mercy and favor, even though they will qualify to earn this mercy on account of their good actions. Allah has made these actions the cause and path that lead to His mercy, favor, pardon and acceptance. Therefore, all this is from Allah Alone and all thanks are due to Him. Allah said next, iAnd they who disbelieve and deny our Aydt are those who will be the dwellers of the Hell-fire. This only demonstrates Allah’s perfect justice, wisdom and judgment, He is never wrong, for He is the Most Wise, Most Just and Most Able.

Among Allah's Favors is that He Prevented the Disbelievers from Fighting the Muslims Allah said, 'Remember the favor of Allah unto you when some people desired (made a plan) to stretch out their hands against you, but (Allah) withheld their hands from you' 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Jabir said, "The Prophet is once stayed at an area and the people spread out seeking shade under various trees. The Prophet hung his weapon on a tree, and a bedouin man came and took possession of the Prophet's weapon and held it aloft. He came towards the Prophet and said, 'Who can protect you from me?' He replied, 'Allah, the Exalted, Most Honored.' The bedouin man repeated his question twice or thrice, each time the Prophet answering him by saying, 'Allah.' The bedouin man then lowered the sword, and the Prophet called his Companions and told them what had happened while the bedouin was sitting next to him, for the Prophet did not punish him.' Ma'mar said that Qatadah used to mention that some Arabs wanted to have the Prophet killed, so they sent that bedouin. Qatadah would then mention this Ayah, (Remember the favor of Allah unto you when some people desired (made a plan) to stretch out their hands against you...) 111

The story of this bedouin man, whose name is Ghawrath bin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1446–1472]

Al-Harith, is mentioned in the Sahib. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, Mujahid and 'Ikrimah said that this Ayah was revealed about Bani An-Nadir, who plotted to drop a stone on the head of the Messenger when he came to them for help to pay the blood money of two persons 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :185. * Al-Bukhari nos: 4135, 4136, 4139.

whom Muslims killed. 11 The Jews left the execution of this plot to 'Amr bin Jhash bin Ka'b and ordered him to throw a stone on the Prophet from above, when he came to them and sat under the wall. Allah told His Prophet about their plot, and he went back to Al-Madinah and his Companions followed him later on. Allah sent down this Ayah concerning this matter. Allah's statement, 'And in Allah let the believers put their trust.' and those who do so, then Allah shall suffice for them and shall protect them from the evil plots of the people. Thereafter, Allah commanded His Messenger to expel Bani An-Nadlr, and he laid siege to their area and forced them to evacuate Al-Madinah. The Prophet had a treaty with the Jews to help him pay the Diah, when warranted.

Indeed, Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel (Jeios), and We appointed twelve leaders among them. And Allah said : "I am with you if you perform the Saldh and give the Zakdh and believe in My Messengers; honor and assist them, and lend to Allah a good loan, verily, I will remit your sins and admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise). But if any of you after this, disbelieved, he has indeed gone astray from the straight way." 13. So, because of their breach of their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts grow hard. They changed the words from their (right) places and abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. And you will not cease to discover deceit in them, except a few of them. But forgive them and overlook (their misdeeds). Verily, Allah loves the doers of good. 414. And from those who call themselves Christians, We took their covenant, but they have abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. So We planted

amongst them enmity and hatred till the Day of Resurrection; and Allah will inform them of what they used to do.} Cursing the People of the Book for Breaking the Covenant Allah commanded His believing servants to fulfill the promises and pledges that He took from them and which they gave His servant and Messenger, Muhammad, peace be upon him. Allah also commanded them to stand for the truth and give correct testimony. He also reminded them of the obvious and subtle favors of the truth and guidance that He granted them. Next, Allah informed them of the pledges and promises that He took from the People of the Book, who were before them, the Jews and Christians. When they broke these promises and covenants, Allah cursed them as a consequence

127 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (12 - 14) (Part-6) and expelled them from His grace and mercy. He also sealed their hearts from receiving guidance and the religion of truth, beneficial knowledge and righteous actions. Allah said, &j} 4 Indeed Allah took the covenant from the Children of Israel and We appointed twelve leaders among them.} These twelve people were leaders who gave the pledge to Allah to listen and obey Allah, His Messenger and His Book on behalf of their tribes. Muhammad bin Ishaq and Ibn 'Abbas said that this occurred when Musa went to fight the mighty enemy (in Palestine), and Allah commanded him to choose a leader from every tribe. The Leaders of Ansar on the Night of 'Aqabah Likewise, when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ took the pledge from the Ansar in the 'Aqabah area, there were twelve leaders from the Ansar. There were three men from the tribe of Aws: Usayd bin Al-Hudayr, Sa'd bin Khaythamah and Rifa'ah bin 'Abdul-Mundhir, or Abu Al-Haytham bin At-Tayhan. There were nine people from the tribe of Khazraj: Abu Umamah As'ad bin Zurarah, Sa'd bin Ar-Rabi', 'Abdullah bin Rawahah, Rafi' bin Malik bin Al-'Ajlani, Al-Bara' bin Ma'rur, Thabalah bin As-Samit, Sa'd bin 'Ubadah, 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Haram and Al-Mundhir bin Umar bin al-Khunays. Ka'b bin Malik mentioned these men in his poem, as recorded by Ibn Ishaq.^{12*} On that night, these men were the leaders or representatives of their tribes by the command of the Prophet. They gave the pledge and promise of allegiance and obedience to the Prophet ﷺ on behalf of their people. Allah said, \$And Allah said, "I am with you...} with My protection, support and aid, hg} if you perform the Salah and give the Zakat and believe in My [1 * At-Tabari 10:113. ,2i Ibn Hisham 2:86-87.

Messengers;} concerning what they bring you of the revelation, i honor and assist them...} and support them on the truth, i and lend to Allah a good loan...} by spending in His cause, seeking to please Him. i verily, I will remit your sins} and errors, I will erase them, cover them, and will not punish you for them, ut £&}\$&} i and admit you to Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise).} thus, protecting you from what you fear and granting you what you seek. Breaking the Covenant Allah said. i But if any of you after this, disbelieved, he has indeed gone astray from the straight way.} Therefore, those who break this covenant, even though they pledged and vowed to keep it, yet, they broke it and denied it ever existed, they have avoided the clear path and deviated from the path of guidance to the path of misguidance. Allah then mentioned the punishment that befell those who broke His covenant and the pledge they gave Him, i So because of their breach of their covenant, We cursed them...} Allah states, because of their breaking the promise that We took from them, We cursed them, deviated them away from the truth, and expelled them from guidance,

i and made their hearts grow hard...} and they do not heed any word of advice that they hear, because of the hardness of their hearts. && i They/ change the words from their (right) places...} Since their

comprehension became corrupt, they behaved treacherously with Allah's Ayat, altering His Book from its apparent meanings which He sent down, and distorting its indications. They attributed to Allah what He did not say, and we seek refuge with Allah from such behavior. 44i LuCiX iand have abandoned a good part of the Message that zoas sent to them.} by not implementing it and by ignoring it. Allah said next, 4£i £ >\$> J0 iAnd you will not cease to discover deceit in them,} such as their plots and treachery against you, O Muhammad, and your Companions. Mujahid said that this Ayah refers to their plot to kill the Messenger of Allah iButforgive them, and overlook (their misdeeds).} This, indeed, is the ultimate victory and triumph. Some of the Salaf said, "You would never treat those who disobey Allah with you better than obeying Allah with them." This way, their hearts will gather around the truth and Allah might lead them to the right guidance. This is why Allah said, 4Verily, Allah loves the doers ofgood.} Therefore, forgive those who err against you. Qatadah said that this Ayah was abrogated with Allah's statement, jfyfX ait Xf—'y. y (11 At-Jabari 10:131.

iFight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day^ . |11 The Christians Also Broke their Covenant with Allah and the Repercussion of this Behavior Allah said, aL. ik£S iAndfrom those who call themselves Christians, We took their covenant, Meaning: 'From those who call themselves Christians and followers of Isa, son of Maryam, while in fact they are not as they claim. We took from them the covenant and pledges that they would follow the Prophet jg, aid him, honor him and follow his footsteps.' And that they would believe in every Prophet whom Allah sends to the people of the earth. They imitated the Jews and broke the promises and the pledges. This is why Allah said, ibut they have abandoned a good part of the Message that was sent to them. So We planted amongst them enmity and hatred till the Day ofResurrection Meaning: "We planted enmity and hatred between them, and they will remain like this until the Day of Resurrection.' Indeed, the numerous Christian sects have always been enemies and adversaries of each other, accusing each other of heresy and cursing each other. Each sect among them excommunicates the other sects and does not allow them entrance to their places of worship. The Monarchist sect accuses the Jacobite sect of heresy, and such is the case with the Nestorians and the Arians. Each sect among them will continue to accuse the other of disbelief and heresy in this life and on the Day when the Witnesses will come forth. Allah then said, t s' 111 At-Tabari 10:134.

mSiirah 5. Al-Ma'idah (15 - 16) (Part-6 iand Allah ivill inform them ofzuhat they used to do. warning and threatening the Christians because of their lies against Allah and His Messenger and their false claims about Allah, hallowed be He above what they say about Him. The Christians attribute a companion and a son to Allah, while He is the One and Only, the All-Sufficient, Who neither begets nor was He begotten, and there is none like unto Him. p dyi; -p-K Sj if Jdif V— J >gdla> Si lSJ-« 4 H-uxJj jy-if 415. O People of the Scripture! Noiv has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that which you used to hide from the Scripture and passing over much. Indeed, there has come to you from Allah a light and a plain Book.) 416. Wherewith Allah guides all those who seek His Pleasure to ways of peace, and He brings them out of darkness by His permission unto light and guides them to a straight path.) Explaining the Truth Through the Messenger and the Qur'an Allah states that He sent His Messenger Muhammad jg with the guidance and the religion of truth to all the people of the earth, the Arabs and non-Arabs, lettered and unlettered. Allah also states that He sent Muhammad sg with clear evidences and the distinction between truth and falsehood. Allah said, P&'R Si 40 People of the

Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that which you used to hide from the Scripture and passing over much.) So the Prophet explained where they altered, distorted, changed and lied about Allah. He also ignored much of what they changed, since it would not bring about any benefit if it was explained. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that Ibn

C iai -- , > . :'''s ~i -»v \$'>">' i- IJj -A*>(*? U>jV ^yXlicr- fcW Ij. il ^*<jjJLS ilj^jS *,lji ‘Abbas said, “He who disbelieves in stoning (the adulterer to death) will have inadvertently disbelieved in the Qur’an, for Allah said, Jj if &&> } p vlg d^; P-H Oi 40 People of the Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger explaining to you much of that zohich you used to hide from the Scripture} and stoning was among the things that they used to hide.” Al-Hakim said, “Its chain is Sahih, and they did not record it.” Allah next mentions the Glorious Qur’an that He sent down to His honorable Prophet 2g, \$J jy y& •&} . >•-* .> > 4?’ 4Indeed, there has come to you from Allah a light and a plain Book. Wherewith Allah guides all those who seek His pleasure to ways of peace.} meaning, ways of safety and righteousness, till **i%iP dS\ Oi |4v*VJ^ 111 Al-Hfikim 4:359.

133Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (17 - 18) (Part-6) iand He brings them out of darkness by His permission unto light and guides them to a straight path.} He thus saves them from destruction and explains to them the best, most clear path. Therefore, He protects them from what they fear, and brings about the best of what they long for, all the while ridding them of misguidance and directing them to the best, most righteous state of being. \$ Oi 0*3 js 'fzis Qg ji\$ lc*i} 4>i,j ULjr ^ O-J t&J of j'jf u&L& Cj cfcjVfj -iii ^ F A < A J f I . I ^ ^ X . aft !•/' - ><• > V a I J // 417. Surely, in disbelief are they who say that Allah is the Messiah, son of Maryam. Say: "Who then has the least power against Allah, if He were to destroy the Messiah, son of Maryam, his mother, and all those who are on the earth together?" And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them. He creates what He wills. And Allah is able to do all things.} 418. And the Jews and the Christians say: "We are the children of Allah and His loved ones." Say: "Why then does He punish you far your sins?" Nay, you are but human beings of those He has created, He forgives whom He wills and He punishes whom He wills. And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them ; and to Him is the return (ofall).} The Polytheism and Disbelief of the Christians Allah states that the Christians are disbelievers because of their claim that ‘Isa, son of Maryam, one of Allah's servants and creatures, is Allah. Allah is holier than what they attribute to Him. Allah then reminds them of His perfect ability over everything and that everything is under His complete control and power,

m 's*' & (g—4' ol j'j! o£. 4if St -j l)I; S*~^ 4CL*r ofjl/' 4 4Say: "WTio then has the least power against Allah, ifHe were to destroy the Messiah, son of Maryam, his mother, and all those who are on the earth together?"j> Therefore, if Allah wills to do that, who would be able to stop Him or prevent Him from doing it? Allah then said, iAnd to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them. He creates what He wills. All things in existence are Allah’s property and creation and He is able to do everything. He is never asked about what He does with His power, domain, justice and greatness so this refutes the Christian creed, may Allah’s continued curses be upon them until the Day of Resurrection. Refuting the People of the Book’s Claim that they are Allah’s Children Allah then refutes the Christians’ and Jews’ false claims and lies, iAnd the Jews and the Christians say, "We are the children of Allah and His loved ones."} They claim: “We are the followers

of Allah's Prophets, who are His children, whom He takes care of. He also loves us." The People of the Book claim in their Book that Allah said to His servant Israel, "You are my firstborn." But they explained this statement in an improper manner and altered its meaning. Some of the People of the Book who later became Muslims refuted this false statement saying, "This statement only indicates honor and respect, as is common in their speech at that time." The Christians claim that Isa said to them, "I will go back to my father and your father," meaning, my Lord and your Lord. It is a fact that the Christians did not claim that they too are Allah's sons as they claimed about 'Isa. Rather this statement by 'Isa only meant to indicate a

135 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (18 - 19) (Part-6) closeness with Allah. This is why when they said that they are Allah's children and loved ones, Allah refuted their claim, 4 Say, "Why then does He punish you for your sins?" } meaning, if you were truly as you claim, Allah's children and loved ones, then why did He prepare the Fire because of your disbelief, lies and false claims? 4 Nay, you are but human beings, of those He has created, } Allah states; you are just like the rest of the children of Adam, and Allah is the Lord of all His creation, 4 He forgives whom He wills and punishes whom He wills. } Allah does what He wills, there is none who can escape His judgement, and He is swift in reckoning. 4 And to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them; } Therefore, everything is Allah's property and under His power and control, } and to Him is the return. } In the end, the return will be to Allah and He will judge between His servants as He will, and He is the Most Just Who is never wrong in His judgment. he £ bb** J jA?' oi Ja» '(£} c£_ &\$&%te %£ ft-& ;i% 419. O People of the Scripture! Now has come to you Our Messenger making (things) clear unto you, after a break in (the series of) Messengers, lest you say: "There came to us no bringer of glad tidings and no wamer." But now has come unto you a bringer of glad tidings and a wamer. And Allah is able to do all things. }

136 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Allah is addressing the People of the Book - the Jews and the Christians, saying that He has sent His Messenger Muhammad sg to them, the Final Prophet, after whom there will be no Prophet or Messenger. Rather, He is the Final Messenger who came after a long time passed between him and Isa, son of Maryam peace be upon them. There is a difference of opinion about the length of time between Isa and Muhammad jg. Abu 'Uthman An-Nahdi and Qatadah were reported to have said that this period was six hundred years. * Al-Bukhari also recorded this opinion from Salman Al-Farisi.*2 * Qatadah said that this period was five hundred and sixty years,*31 while Ma'mar said that it is five hundred and forty years.*4 * Some said that this period is six hundred and twenty years. There is no contradiction here if we consider the fact that those who said that this period was six hundred years were talking about solar years, while the second refers to lunar years, since there is a difference of about three years between every one hundred lunar and solar years. As in Allah's statement, ill; j i 4 Attd they stayed in their Cave three hundred years, adding nine meaning, nine more lunar years to substitute for the difference between lunar and solar years, thus agreeing with the three hundred years that the People of the Book knew about. We should assert again that the time period we mentioned here was between Isa, the last Prophet to the Children of Israel, and Muhammad jg, the Last Prophet and Messenger among the children of Adam. In the Sahlh collected by Al-Bukhari, Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Jw hf «/, among all people, have the most right to the son of Maryam, for there was no Prophet between Him and /.«*5 m Al-Baghawi 2:23. * Fath Al-B&ri 7 :324 * Al-Baghawi 2:23. 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :186. * Fath Al-B&ri 6:550.

This Hadith refutes the opinion of Al-Qudal and others, that there was a Prophet after Isa called Khalid bin Sinan. Allah sent Muhammad jg after a period of time during which there was no Prophet, clear path, or unchanged religions. Idol worshipping, fire worshipping and cross worshipping flourished during this time. Therefore, the bounty of sending Muhammad jjfe was the perfect bounty at a time when he was needed the most. Evil had filled the earth by then, and tyranny and ignorance had touched all the servants, except a few of those who remained loyal to the true teachings of previous Prophets, such as some Jewish rabbis, Christian priests and Sabian monks. Imam Ahmad recorded that lyad bin Himar Al-Mujashl said that the Prophet jg gave a speech one day and said, ji- ^Ij 5i J_)<l j*J t* '(*-\$1 U (lie- V*! p-fc'jt- p ^jSfi ^f '}> 2ii jj lUim. jJip cJ^lj i iwj ! ijlij ijjiZ*\ , uiij viJLaj Jy~\ of f oj jJ tjUi&j LO li of^SJ iEl«Jl aJl-.wj V .i j-.' > , »;• , r; . k -)_-> 1 l^S I . <Jub t o a^PJLl i Ijaw 1 Li->- wa»!j i iiLL& JjaJ ^j&^pIj JauJL* jLLJJ- jS ! aL>J1 (Ja1j iilLop 3jU-U»l * * . • * • *' ** > * * i » # * i " * " r»ti # <> ji-a 'J Ifii V i5-d' ! <'!->• jllll Jifj . [JjLill] Jll J V j_£A)l ^tidlj vVt* V_j ^af Oj w~ ; V — OJLt “ L*_J ^f iiUf^uJ >3 vi^ V)^ V J433 VI oi ji} a^UJl ; :b-liij - oikii jf j_>di - ilJUJ «My Lord has commanded me to teach you what you have no knowledge of and of which He taught me this day, 'All the wealth that I gave to My servants is permissible. I created all My servants Hunafa (monotheists). But, the devils came to them and deviated them from their religion, prohibited for them

what 1 allowed and commanded them to associate others with Me [in worship], which I gave no permission for.' Then Allah looked at the people of the earth and disliked them all, the Arabs and non-Arabs among them, except a few from among the Children of Israel. Allah said (to me), 7 only sent you to test you and to test with you. I sent to you a Book that cannot be washed by water (it is eternal), and you will read it while asleep and while awake.' Allah has also Commanded me to bum (destroy) Quraysli. So I said, 'O Lord! They will smash my head and leave it like a piece of bread.' He said, 7 will drive them out as they drove you out, and when you invade them We will help you. Spend on them (your companions) and We will spend on you, send an army and We will smd five armies like it (in its support). Fight with those who obey you, against those who disobey you. And the inhabitants of Paradise are three: a just, prosperous, and charitable ruler; A merciful man who has a kind heart toward every relative and every Muslim; a forgiving, poor man with dependants [who is charitable]. And the inhabitants of the Fire are five: the weak one with no religion ; those who follow after you not Jbr family reasons nor wealth; and the treacherous who does not hide his treachery, acting treacherous in even tlte most insignificant matters; and a person who comes every morning and every evening, is cheating yourfamily or your wealth. '» And he mentioned the stingy, or the liar, and the foulmouthed person.” Therefore, the Hadith states that Allah looked at the people of the earth and disliked them all, both the Arabs and non- Arabs among them, except a few among the Children of Israel, or a few among the People of the Book as Muslim recorded.'2 The religion was distorted and changed for the people of the earth until Allah sent Muhammad jg, and Allah, thus, guided the creatures and took them away from the darkness to the light and placed them on a clear path and a glorious Law. Allah said, ifix% u ijjs ilest you say, "There came unto us no bringer of glad tidings * l * Ahmad 4 :162, and Muslim, as noted below. * Muslim 4 :2197.

ixtsui^ " T esm 1 L\$!>- li *—ijJliQjy - _~ -hjj ‘~J jJU_iJj3jiU<_ ^ - * ' -.»V £-; •> "I.; -• _ <r? *Cw~tl tLA^O'rt-fl"!^' L-gJpJU QAfl .^>.-4 i I "its ^<jj 1?..J ^jV i—jL*j^3^ ill'. L* (^gX'-L'-J iiU _^j owLaJ^iIjj «^C-^ii3^AjjvdJaJI \3j->- <iU j_Jll5lv_-2>&»o' l> f|> ,iilii4-i-1jiS,£ijj ,dl -*> f. .:.{. >

^-s'> s" Ijlji ^ *—* Aj-L^ij tjU a*_^> »*_J— and no wamer. meaning, so that you, who changed the true religion, do not make it an excuse and say, “No Messenger came to us bringing glad tidings and warning against evil.” There has come to you a bringer of good news and a warner, Muhammad m- 4i-ir* }lr 3^=>& iAnd Allah is able to do all things. Ibn Jarir said this part of the Ayah means, “I am able to punish those who disobey Me and to reward those who obey Me.”¹¹ ' *iyl 'J-y vjj P 1* fSS^Cj S'jti fS^i-j '2CA jli ij ',£& ^11 *li 2k S'ij Vj Jit jJi J—iJiJi iA 'j— WyS &- IZ+L-li jl Ujj bji Ijj j[yii .V'O, ijUiUt ^jLjl Jif C*jK ce oyi) jli ^.^SjU-'k liji CJL i^£.^ie t^C. 4 #53 ^ ^^ :^£i> ^ Stfji^ ytsr t5~ii —sJljj Oil J~»i£ ijilj U (jj L«Ai-jS J) 0), ijq !'r' ^yji ^j-iu 'j o; JU Jf O-b Ufj J ^ * b^fjl Lf>^ Jli ^:n'A^ijf [II At-Jabari 10:158.

420. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my people! Remember the favor of Allah to you: when He made Prophets among you, made you kings and gave you what He had not given to any other among the nations (AI-'Alamm)."} 421. "O my people! Enter the Holy Land which Allah has assigned to you and turn not back; for then you will be returned as losers."} 422. They said: "O Musa! In it are a people of great strength, and we shall never enter it, till they leave it; when they leave, then we will enter."} 423. Two men of those who feared (Allah and) on whom Allah had bestowed His grace said: "Assault them through the gate; for when you are in, victory will be yours. And put your trust in Allah if you are believers indeed."} 424. They said: "O Musa! We shall never enter it as long as they are there. So go, you and your Lord, and fight you tivo, we are sitting right here."} 425. He [Musa] said: "O my Lord! I have power only over myself and my brother, so Ifruq us from the rebellious people!"} 426 . (Allah) said: "Therefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through the land. So do not greive for the rebellious people."} Musa Reminds His People of Allah's Favors on Them; The Jews Refuse to Enter the Holy Land Allah states that His servant, Messenger, to whom He spoke directly, Musa, the son of Imran, reminded his people that among the favors Allah granted them, is that He will give them all of the good of this life and the Hereafter, if they remain on the righteous and straight path. Allah said, 4And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "O my people! Remember the favor of Allah to you, when He made Prophets among you,} for whenever a Prophet died, another rose among them, from the time of their father Ibrahim and thereafter. There were many Prophets among the Children of Israel

calling to Allah and warning against His torment, until Isa was sent as the final Prophet from the Children of Israel. Allah then sent down the revelation to the Final Prophet and Messenger, Muhammad, the son of 'Abdullah, from the offspring of Ismail, the son of Ibrahim, peace be upon them. Muhammad 3S5 is the most honorable Prophet of all times. Allah said next, imade you kings^ 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented: "Having a servant, a wife and a house." * In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "A wife and a servant, and, Si CJ p e iand gave you what He had not given to any other among the nations ('Alamin).\$ means, during their time."*2 * Al-Hakim said, "Sahih. according to the criteria of the Two Sahih, but they did not collect it." Qatadah said, "They were the first people to take servants. A Hadlth states, l Aajj O oJHP 'tf.rt Jt kl ^ If hUjJiSa, din 2 «He among you who wakes up while healthy in body, safe in his family and having the provision for that very day, is as if the world and all that was in it were collected for /iim.n*4' Allah's statement, 4Sv£«!' St 'S—1 vjj p ! iand gave you what He had not given to any other among the nations

(Al-'Alamin) means, during your time, as we stated. The Children of Israel *** 'Abdur-Razzaq 1 :187. Al-Hakim 2:312. 131 At-Tabari 10:163. * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:11.

142 Tafair Ibn Kathir were the most honorable among the people of their time, compared to the Greek, Copts and the rest of mankind. Allah said in another Ayah, uuijl J* >> at s SiZrA XjA. '-:?' i'4) iAnd indeed We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, and the understanding of the Scripture and its laws, and the Prophethood ; and provided them with good things, and preferred them above the nations (Al-'Alamfn)> Allah said, Jli *41'* l*T" ^ 'jit* ^ pS^LU% pi*J \$ £1 js X \$They said: "O Musa! Make for us a god as they have gods." He said: "Verily, you are an ignorant people." [Musa added:] "Verily, these people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in (idol worship)." And all that they are doing is in vain. He said: "Shall I seek far you a god other than Allalt, while He has given you superiority over the nations.") Therefore, they were the best among the people of their time. The Muslim Ummah is more respected and honored before Allah, and has a more perfect legislative code and system of life, it has the most honorable Prophet, the larger kingdom, more provisions, wealth and children, a larger domain and more lasting glory than the Children of Israel. Allah said, iThus We have made you, a just (the best) nation, that you be witnesses over mankind.) We mentioned the Mutawatir Hadiths about the honor of this Ummah and its status and honor with Allah, when we explained Allah's statement in Surah Al-'Imran (3), C+jf* iil 'jf- pJ?) 4You are the best ofpeoples ever raised up far mankind...)) Allah states next that Musa encouraged the Children of

Israel to perform Jihad and enter Jerusalem, which was under their control during the time of their father Ya'qub. Ya'qub and his children later moved with his children and household to Egypt during the time of Prophet Yusuf. His offspring remained in Egypt until their exodus with Musa. They found a mighty, strong people in Jerusalem who had previously taken it over. Mfisa, Allah's Messenger, ordered the Children of Israel to enter Jerusalem and fight their enemy, and he promised them victory and triumph over the mighty people .if they did so. They declined, rebelled and defied his order and were punished for forty years by being lost, wandering in the land uncertain of where they should go. This was their punishment for defying Allah's command. Allah said that Musa ordered them to enter the Holy Land, iwhich Allah has assigned to you} meaning, which Allah has promised to you by the words of your father Isra'il, that it is the inheritance of those among you who believe. if- i>jy iand turn not back} in flight from Jihad. A. ' tfif f > > • i" ...for then you will be returned as losers." They said, "O Musa! In it are a people of great strength, and we shall never enter it, till they leave it; when they leave, then we will enter."} Their excuse was this, in this very town you commanded us to enter and fight its people, there is a mighty, strong, vicious people who have tremendous physique and physical ability. We are unable to stand against these people or fight them. Therefore, they said, we are incapable of entering this city as long as they are still in it, but if they leave it, we will enter it. Otherwise, we cannot stand against them.

111 At-Tabari 10:176-178.

The Righteous Response ofthe CompanionsDuring the Battle ofBadr Compare this to the better response the Companions gave to the Messenger of Allah during the battle of Badr, when he asked for their advice about fighting the Quraysh army that came to protect the caravan led by Abu Sufyan. When the Muslim army missed the caravan and the Quraysh army, between nine hundred and one thousand

strong, helmeted and drawing closer, Abu Bakr stood up and said something good. Several more Muhajirin also spoke, all the while the Messenger of Allah ﷺ saying, «اَجِلْ—جِيْ اِجْلًا Advise me, O Muslim to inquiring of what the Ansar, the majority then, had to say. Sa'd bin Mu'adh said, "It looks like you mean us, O Messenger of Allah! By He Who has sent you with the Truth! If you seek to cross this sea and went in it, we will follow you and none among us will remain behind. We would not hate for you to lead us to meet our enemy tomorrow. We are patient in war, vicious in battle. May Allah allow you to witness from our efforts what comforts your eyes. Therefore, march forward with the blessing of Allah." The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was pleased with the words of Sa'd and was encouraged to march on. Abu Bakr bin Marduyah recorded that Anas said that when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ went to Badr, he asked the Muslims for their opinion, and "Umar gave his. The Prophet ﷺ again asked the Muslims for their opinion and the Ansar said, "O Ansar! It is you whom the Prophet wants to hear." They said, "We will never say as the Children of Israel said to Moses, 'So go, you and your Lord, and fight you two, we are sitting right here.' By He Who has sent you with the Truth! If you took the camels to Bark Al-Ghimad (near Makkah) we shall follow you." 111 At-Tabari 13:399.

146 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Imam Ahmad, An-Nasab and Ibn Hibban * also recorded this Hadith. In the Book of Al-Maghdzi and At-Tafsir, Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "On the day of Badr, Al-Miqdad said, 'O Messenger of Allah! We will never say to you what the Children of Israel said to Moses, 'So go, you and your Lord, and fight you two, we are sitting right here.' Rather, march on and we will be with you.' The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was satisfied after hearing this statement."*2 Musa Supplicates to Allah Against the Jews Musa said, 4 a' ffrL CL, jjiE jLj y ^ cfr 4"0 my Lord! I have power only over myself and my brother, so separate us from the rebellious people!" When the Children of Israel refused to fight, Musa became very angry with them and supplicated to Allah against them, tilpl V p} 40 tny Lord! I have power only over myself and my brother> meaning, only I and my brother Harun among them will obey, implement Allah's command and accept the call, 4So Ifruq us from the rebellious people!} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Meaning, judge between us and them."*3 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported similarly from him.*4 * Ad-Dahhak said that the Ayah means, "Judge Ahmad 3 :105 , An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :334 and Ibn Hibban 7 :109 The chain for this narration is not authentic, but some of the story is supported by the narration that follows as well as the one before it. ' Al-Bukhari no . 4609 * At-Jabari 10:188. At-Tabari 10:189.

and decide between us and them." ' Other scholars said that the Ayah means, "Separate between us and them." Forbidding the Jews from Entering the Holy Land for Forty Years Allah said, &&&&4 iTherefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through the landf When Musa supplicated against the Jews for refusing to fight in Jihad, Allah forbade them from entering the land for forty years. They wandered about lost in the land of At-Tih, unable to find their way out. During this time, tremendous miracles occurred, such as the clouds that shaded them and the manna and quails Allah sent down for them. Allah brought forth water springs from solid rock, and the other miracles that He aided Musa bin Imran with. During this time, the Tawrah was revealed and the Law was established for the Children of Israel and the Tabernacle of the Covenant was erected. Conquering Jerusalem Allah's statement, ifor forty years defines, \$o?jVl 4 iin distraction they will wander through the land .> When these years ended, Yuwsha' bin NQn led those who remained among them and the second generation, and laid siege to Jerusalem, conquering it on a Friday afternoon. When

the sun was about to set and Yuwsha' feared that the Sabbath would begin, he said (to the sun), "You are commanded and I am commanded, as well. O Allah! Make it stop setting for me. Allah made the sun stop setting until Yuwsha' bin Nun 111 At-Tabari 10:189.

conquered Jerusalem. Next, Allah commanded Yuwsha' to order the Children of Israel to enter Jerusalem from its gate while bowing and saying Hittah, meaning, 'remove our sins.' Yet, they changed what they were commanded and entered it while dragging themselves on their behinds and saying, 'Habbah (a seed) in Sha'rah (a hair)." We mentioned all of this in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented, . »t)f . ^ o' -Vt * ^ iTherefore it is forbidden to them for forty years; in distraction they will wander through the land "They wandered in the land for forty years, during which Musa and Harun died, as well as everyone above forty years of age. When the forty years ended, Yuwsha* son of Nun assumed their leadership and later conquered Jerusalem. When Yuwsha' was reminded that the day was Friday and the sun was about to set, while they were still attacking Jerusalem, he feared that the Sabbath might begin. Therefore, he said to the sun, 'I am commanded and you are commanded.' Allah made the sun stop setting and the Jews conquered Jerusalem and found wealth unseen before. They wanted to let the fire consume the booty, but the fire would not do that. Yuwsha' said, 'Some of you have committed theft from the booty.' So he summoned the twelve leaders of the twelve tribes and took the pledge from them. Then, the hand of one of them became stuck to the hand of Yuwsha' and Yuwsha' said, "You committed the theft, so bring it forth.' So, that man brought a cow's head made of gold with two eyes made of precious stones and a set of teeth made of pearls. When Yuwsha' added it to the booty, the fire consumed it, as they were prohibited to keep the booty." There is evidence supporting all of this in the Sahih. Allah Comforts Musa Comforting MQsa, Allah said i-tfJI Jt'yill jfr J-b Su\$> 4So do not grieve for the rebellious people. A Similar version was recorded by At-Tabari 10 :193

Allah said: Do not feel sorrow or sadness over My judgment against them, for they deserve such judgment. This story chastises the Jews, exposes their defiance of Allah and His Messenger, and their refusal to obey the order for Jihad. They were weak and could not bear the thought of fighting their enemy, being patient, and enduring this way. This occurred although they had the Messenger of Allah and the one whom He spoke to among them, the best of Allah's creation that time. Their Prophet promised them triumph and victory against their enemies. They also witnessed the torment and punishment of drowning with which Allah punished their enemy Fir'awn and his soldiers, so that their eyes were pleased and comforted. All this did not happen too long ago, yet they refused to perform Jihad against people who had less than a tenth of the power and strength than the people of Egypt had. Therefore, the evil works of the Jews were exposed to everyone, and the exposure was such an enormous one that the night, or the tail, can never cover its tracks. They were also blinded by their ignorance and transgression. Thus, they became hated by Allah, and they became His enemies. Yet, they claim that they are Allah's children and His loved ones! May Allah curse their faces that were transformed to the shape of swine and apes, and may Allah's curse accompany them to the raging Fire. May Allah make them abide in the Fire for eternity, and He did; all thanks are due to Him. <27 . And recite to them the story of the two sons of Adam in truth; when each offered a sacrifice, it was accepted from the one but not from the other. The latter said to the former: "I will surely, kill you." The former said: "Verily, Allah accepts

150 Tafsir Ibn Kathir only from those who have Taqwa.) 428. "If you do stretch your hand against me to kill me, I shall never stretch my hand against you to kill you, for I fear Allah; the Lord of all that exists.") 429. "Verily, I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours, then you will be one of the dwellers of the Fire, and that is the recompense of the wrongdoers.") 430. So the soul of the other encouraged him and made fair-seeming to him the murder of his brother; he murdered him and became one of the losers. 431. Then Allah sent a crow who scratched the ground to show him how to hide the dead body of his brother. He said: "Woe to me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?" Then he became one of those who regretted.) The Story of Habil (Abel) and Qabil (Cain) Allah describes the evil end and consequence of transgression, envy and injustice in the story of the two sons of Adam, Habil and Qabil. One of them fought against the other and killed him out of envy and transgression, because of the bounty that Allah gave his brother and because the sacrifice that he sincerely offered to Allah was accepted. The murdered brother earned forgiveness for his sins and was admitted into Paradise, while the murderer failed and earned a losing deal in both the lives. Allah said, 4 And recite to them the story of the two sons of Adam in truth;) meaning, tell these envious, unjust people, the brothers of swine and apes from the Jews and their likes among mankind,

the story of the two sons of Adam, Habil and Qabil, as many

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1472–1509]

scholars among the Salaf and later generations said. Allah's statement, 4 in truth;) means, clearly and without ambiguity, alteration,

confusion, change, addition or deletion. Allah said in other Ayat, i V i Verily, this is the true narrative [about the story of 'Isa,] > 1 ~ ^_j » U ii U* joi < We narrate unto you their story with truth, } and, 4 i > j' Jv & i Ae 4 Such is 'Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a statement of truth. } Several scholars among the Salaf and the later generations said that Allah allowed Adam to marry his daughters to his sons because of the necessity of such action. They also said that in every pregnancy, Adam was given a twin, a male and a female, and he used to give the female of one twin, to the male of the other twin, in marriage. Habil's sister was not beautiful while Qabil's sister was beautiful, resulting in Qabil wanting her for himself, instead of his brother. Adam refused unless they both offer a sacrifice, and he whose sacrifice was accepted, would marry Qabil's sister. Habil's sacrifice was accepted, while Qabil's sacrifice was rejected, and thus what Allah told us about them occurred. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said - that during the time of Adam - "The woman was not allowed in marriage for her male twin, but Adam was commanded to marry her to any of her other brothers. In each pregnancy, Adam was given a twin, a male and a female. A beautiful daughter was once born for Adam and another one that was not beautiful. So the twin brother of the ugly daughter said, 'Marry your sister to me and I will marry my sister to you.' He said, 'No, for I have more right to my sister.' So they both offered a sacrifice. The sacrifice of the one who offered the sheep was accepted while the sacrifice of the other [the twin brother of the beautiful daughter], which consisted of some produce, was not accepted. So the latter killed his brother." This story has a better than good chain of narration.' 111 At-Tabari 10:223.

The statement, jt iit Jlij £![] i "Verily, Allah accepts only from those who have Taqwa.} who fear Allah in their actions. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ad-Darda' said, "If I become certain that Allah has

accepted even one prayer from me, it will be better for me than this life and all that in it. This is because Allah says, ^{L5^} iVerily, Allah accepts only from the those who have Taqwd.} The statement, vj t tjjJ i" If you do stretch your hand against me to kill me, I shall never stretch my hand against you to kill you, for Ifour Allah; the Lord of all that exists Qabll's brother, the pious man whose sacrifice was accepted because of his piety, said to his brother, who threatened to kill him without justification, &} [Csfi. -kX 2Z 31 if you do stretch your hand against me to kill me, I shall never stretch my hand against you to kill you,} I will not commit the same evil act that you threaten to commit, so that I will not earn the same sin as you, Jit ifor Ifear Allah; the Lord of the all that exists.} and, as a result, I will not commit the error that you threaten to commit. Rather, I will observe patience and endurance. Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "By Allah! Habll was the stronger of the two men. But, fear of Allah restricted his hand." The Prophet jg said in a Hadith recorded in the Two Sahihs, JjUHi L jUL -Jjl <>-y lij» «When two Muslims fight (meet) each other with their sivords, both the murderer as well as the murdered will go to the

Hellfire. They said, "O Allah's Messenger! It is all right for the murderer, but what about the victim?" Allah's Messenger jg replied, t- j>- jl£ "He surely had the intention to kill his comrade . Imam Ahmad recorded that, at the beginning of the calamity that TJthman suffered from, Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas said, "I bear witness that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, iUt; J If jf- IfJ JU-U3I j tilty "There will be a Fitnah, and he who sits idle during it is better than he who stands up, and he who stands up in it is better than he who walks, and he who walks is better than he who is walking at a fast pace. When he was asked, What if someone enters my home and stretched his hand to kill me?' He said, J> "Be just like (the pious) son of Adam .n"*21 At-Tirmidhi also recorded it this way, and said, "This Hadith is Hasan, and similar is reported on this subject from Abu Hurayrah, Khabbab bin Al-Aratt, Abu Bakr, Ibn Mas'ud, Abu Waqid and Abu Musa."*31 The Qur'an continues, ifjiSjM iifZi \yi J i"Verily , I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours, then you will be one of the dwellers of the Fire, and that is the recompense of the wrongdoers."} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and Qatadah said that, ^ FathAl-Bari 13:35, Muslim 4:2214. Ahmad 1 :185. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :436

154 Tafstr Ibn Kathfr 4"Verily, I intend to let you draw my sin on yourself as well as yours..."} means, the sin of murdering me, in addition to your previous sins. Ibn Jarir recorded this! Allah's statement, 4So the soul of the other encouraged him and made fair-seeming to him the murder of his brother; he murdered him and became one of the losers.} means, his conscience encouraged him to kill his brother by making it seem like a sensible thing to do, so he killed him, even after his brother admonished him. Ibn Jarir said, "When he wanted to kill his brother, he started to twist his neck. So Shaytan took an animal and placed its head on a rock, then he took another rock, and smashed its head with it until he killed it while the son of Adam was looking. So he did the same thing to his brother."121 Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this. 'Abdullah bin Wahb said that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his father said, "Qabll held Habll by the head to kill him, so Habll laid down for him and Qabll started twisting Habfl's head, not knowing how to kill him. Shaytan came to Qabll and said, "Do you want to kill him?' He said, 'Yes.' Shaytan said, Take that stone and throw it on his head.' So Qabll took the stone and threw it at his brother's head and smashed his head. Shaytan then went to Hawwa' in a hurry and said to her, 'O Hawwa'! Qabll killed Habll.' She asked him, "Woe to you! What does 1011' mean?' He said, "He will no longer eat, drink or move.' She said, 'And that is death?' He said, *Yes it is.' So

she started to weep until Adam came to her while she was weeping and said. What is the matter with you?' She did not answer him. He asked her two more times, but she did not answer him. So he said, *You and your daughters will inherit the practice of weeping, while I and my sons are free of it.'" Ibn Abi Hatim recorded it. Allah's statement. 111 At-Tabari 10:215-216. 121 AMabari 4:536.

Cxi iAnd became one of the losers in this life and the Hereafter, and which loss is worse than this? Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, If Jj' *Any soul that is unjustly killed, then the first son of Adam will carry a burden of its shedding, for he zoas the first to practice the crime ofmurder.^ The Group, with the exception of Abu Dawud, also recorded this Hadith™ Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr used to say, "The son of Adam, who killed his brother, will be the most miserable among men. There is no blood shed on earth since he killed his brother, until the Day of Resurrection, but he will cany a burden from it, for he was the first person to establish murder."131 Allah said, Z&4 jli ^ && 4 dfZ\$& cxi £-4* J/jti 'Ai* jit cJ iThen Allah sent a crow who scratched the ground to show him how to hide the dead body of his brother. He (the murderer) said, "Woe to me!Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body ofmy brother?" Then he became one of those who regretted As-Suddi said that the Companions said, "When his brother died, Qabll left him on the bare ground and did not know how to buiy him. Allah sent two crows, which fought with each other until one of them killed the other. So it dug a hole and threw sand over the dead corpse (which it placed in the hole). When Qabll saw that, he said, 111 Ahmad 1 :383. 121 Fath Al-Bari 12:198, Muslim 3:1303, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:436, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :334 , Ibn Majah 2 :873 131 At-Tabari 10:219.

J V. Si. sp a &>;> :rp yj3l Ili 4'Woe fo me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?"*™ 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "A crow came to the dead corpse of another crow and threw sand over it, until it hid it in the ground. He who killed his brother said, Sh c,1 \$£> S/X 4Woe to me! Am I not even able to be as this crow and to hide the dead body of my brother?*'2' Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on the statement, Si '£& iThen he became one of those who regretted. "Allah made him feel sorrow after the loss that he earned." \m&i ' saga jdi 4^& _^sCSli==uijffd £.it *Vf ^ j»r-) ,ij JJ4I1I '3T>*- jLjijjl ijiiJaj laL-j -^L-U'a Lr°s'd'e^ ^ jL->-jj aii 0<r^?j3s-£r The Swift Punishment for Transgression and Cutting the Relations oftheWomb A Hadith states that the Prophet said, 111 At-Tabari 10:225. 121 At-Tabari 10:226.

jj La £e UjJLl ijyS' ai 1 jf L/f «'There is no sin that is more worthy of Allah hastening its punishment in this life, in addition to wltat He has in store for its offender in the Hereafter, more than transgression and cutting the relations of the ivomb.n The act of Qabll included both of these. We are Allah's and to Him is our return. 4 idi "f (Jjjj _£ju dlil jil ja /jl JajJ, jaj 6-Srf i\$3 tltl -*1 I?; d uiC'A'^ijj^Lil jfHi 4 -*44 5! jL Li-ij f jl jl Ijdi cfjV' 4 Sit OjSijU* 0;^ 4 -^4'i ui'jV' ^ jl oi (*-4*-jl> ^ i&g 6i^ & \# i>\% -o# 4 girt <Z-& 432. Because of that, We ordained for the Children of Israel that if anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind. And indeed, there came to them Our Messengers with Al-Bayyindt, even then after that many of than continued to exceed the limits in the land!} 433 . The recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and do mischief in the land is only that they shall be killed or crucified, or their hands and their feet be cut

off on opposite sides, or be exiled from the land. That is their disgrace in this world, and a great torment is theirs in the Hereafter.} 434. Except for those who (having fled away and then) came back (as Muslims) with repentance before they fall into your power; in that case, know that Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Abu Dawud 5:208.

Human Beings Should Respect the Sanctity of Other Human Beings Allah says, because the son of Adam killed his brother in transgression and aggression, We ordained for the Children of Israel... meaning, We legislated for them and informed them, \L.S. JI Qi (S uj f j Vi 4 f Z Ci j-ju lilij jii j til i4 l f =*> util / anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind.} The Ayah states, whoever kills a soul without justification - such as in retaliation for murder or for causing mischief on earth - will be as if he has killed all mankind, because there is no difference between one life and another. and if anyone saved a life...} by preventing its blood from being shed and believing in its sanctity, then all people will have been saved from him, so, i\ JI U it til iit would be as if he saved the life of all mankind.} Al-A'mash and others said that Abu Salih said that Abu Hurayrah said, "I entered on Tjthman when he was under siege in his house and said, I came to give you my support. Now, it is good to fight (defending you) O Leader of the Faithful!' He said, 'O Abu Hurayrah! Does it please you that you kill all people, including me?' I said, 'No.' He said, If you kill one man, it is as if you killed all people. Therefore, go back with my permission for you to leave. May you receive your reward and be saved from burden.' So I went back and did not fight.'" 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "It is as Allah has stated, L _; 4-j CS l ^ = o uj f j V f 4 y L li 31 jjaj i Li f * }

Ja-iI til \itiS if anyone killed a person not in retaliation of murder, or (and) to spread mischief in the land - it would be as if he killed all mankind, and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind. Saving life in this case occurs by not killing a soul that Allah has forbidden. So this is the meaning of saving the life of all mankind, for whoever forbids killing a soul without justification, the lives of all people will be saved from him.'" Similar was said by Mujahid; iAnd if anyone saved a life...} means, he refrains from killing a soul.*2 ' Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that Allah's statement, iit would be as if he killed all mankind..} means, "Whoever kills one soul that Allah has forbidden killing, is just like he who kills all mankind."*3 * Said bin Jubayr said, "He who allows himself to shed the blood of a Muslim, is like he who allows shedding the blood of all people. He who forbids shedding the blood of one Muslim, is like he who forbids shedding the blood of all people." In addition, Ibn Jurayj said that Al-A'raj said that Mujahid commented on the Ayah, iit would be as if he killed all mankind,} "He who kills a believing soul intentionally, Allah makes the Fire of Hell his abode, He will become angry with him, and curse him, and has prepared a tremendous punishment for him, equal to if he had killed all people, his punishment will still be the same." Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that the Ayah, 111 At-Tabari 10:235. ' At-Tabari 10:236. ' At-Tabari 10:233.

260 Tafsir Ibn Kathtir til iiti.1 and if anyone saved a life, it would be as if he saved the life of all mankind . means, "He who does not kill anyone, then the lives of people are safe from him."111 Warning Those who Commit Mischief Allah said, OiJ JS>;> 4 And indeed, there came to them Our Messengers with Al- Baxjyindt,} meaning, clear evidences, signs and proofs, uj f j V >' 4 IT rf j g h % ieven then after that many of them continued to exceed the limits in the land!} This Ayah chastises and

criticizes those who commit the prohibitions, after knowing that they are prohibited from indulging in them. The Jews of Al-Madīnah, such as Banu Qurayzah, An-Nadlir and Qaynuqa', used to fight along with either Khazraj or Aws, when war would erupt between them during the time of Jdhiliyyah. When these wars would end, the Jews would ransom those who were captured and pay the blood money for those who were killed. Allah criticized them for this practice in Surat Al-Baqarah, 4 (Xukka Ojrf-J Cif* pi p g'ojppj AAj fE=A\c. \Sj& d\j Cj'jSWj | Obj+liJ 'if Uj y'iif d'. ojv. tijif 4 i) ^c, 4 rp,0 tii (remember) zuhen We took your covenant (saying) : Shed id At-Tabari 10:235.

not your (peoples) blood, nor turn out your mvn people from their dwellings. Then, (this) you ratified and (to this) you bear witness. After this, it is you luho kill one another and drive out a party of your own from their homes, assist (their enemies) against them, in sin and transgression. And if they come to you as captives, you ransom them, although their expulsion was forbidden to you. Then do you believe in a part of the Scripture and reject the rest? Then what is the recompense of those who do so among you, except disgrace in the life of this world, and on the Day of Resurrection they shall be consigned to the most grievous torment. And Allah is not unaivare of what you do.} [2:84-85] The Punishment of those Who Cause Mischief in the Land Allah said next, ijiLu jl IjLj Jfjfi 4 Sif ,>jji i Cc>t} jl <^4- oi ^ jl iThe recompense of those xoho wage war against Allah and His Messenger and do mischief in the land is only that they shall be killed or crucified or their hands and their feet be cut offon the opposite sides, or be exiledfrom the land.} *Wage war mentioned here means, oppose and contradict, and it includes disbelief, blocking roads and spreading fear in the fairways. Mischief in the land refers to various types of evil. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ikrimah and Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that the Ayat, 4/Au oui' Cl[] iThe recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger} until, sSf Sj> iAllah is Of-Forgiving, Most Merciful,} “Were revealed about ‘ ijC idolators. Therefore, the Ayah decrees that, whoever amongthem repents before you apprehend them, then you have no right to punish them. This Ayah does not save a Muslim from punishment if he kills, causes mischief in the land or wages

war against Allah and His Messenger and then joins rank with the disbelievers, before the Muslims are able to catch him. He will still be liable for punishment for the crimes he committed.”¹¹¹ Abu Dawud and An-Nasal recorded that ‘Ikrimah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah, 4Thc recompense of those who ivage xoar against Allah ami His Messenger and do mischief in the land...\$ “Was revealed concerning the idolators, those among them who repent before being apprehended, they will still be liable for punishment for the crimes they committed.” The correct opinion is that this Ayah is general in meaning and includes the idolators and all others who commit the types of crimes the Ayah mentioned. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Abu Qilabah ‘Abdullah bin Zayd Al-Jarmi, said that Anas bin Malik said, “Eight people of the ‘Ukl tribe came to the Messenger of Allah \$£; and gave him their pledge to follow Islam. Al-Madinah’s climate did not suit them and they became sick and complained to Allah’s Messenger So he said, sGo with our shephard to be treated by the milk and urine of his camels . So they went as directed, and after they drank from the camels’ milk and urine, they became healthy, and they killed the shepherd and drove away all the camels. The news reached the Prophet ^5 and he sent (men) in their pursuit and they were captured. He then ordered that their hands and feet be cut off (and it was done), and their eyes were branded with heated pieces of iron. Next, they were put in the sun until they died.” This is the wording of Muslim. In another narration for this Hadith, it was

mentioned that these people were from the tribes of 'Ukl or 'Uraynah. Another narration reported that these people were put in the Harrah area (of Al-Madlnah), and when they asked for water, no water was given to them. ,3) 111 At-Jabari 10:244. 121 Abu Dawud 4 :536, An-Nasal 7 : 10 1 |3) Fath Al-Bari 12:114, Muslim 3 : 1296.

163 Surah 5. Al-Md'idah (32 - 34) (Part-6) Allah said, 31 i£ (•-t-'ij'i ^a-jj f jl ijiiLu c> if it they shall be killed or crucified or their hands and their feet be cut off on the opposite sides, or be exiled from the land.) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah, 'He who takes up arms in Muslim land and spreads fear in the fairways and is captured, the Muslim Leader has the choice to either have him killed, crucified or cut off his hands and feet.'¹¹¹ Similar was said by Sa'Id bin Al-Musayyib, Mujahid, 'Ata', Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and Ad- Dahhak, as Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir recorded.¹² * This view is supported by the fact that the word Aw (or), indicates a choice. As Allah said, its. y cr i The penalty is an offering, brought to the Ka'bah, of an eatable animal equivalent to the one he killed, as adjudged by two just men among you; or, for expiation, he should feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting.}[5:95] Allah said, jl (j* ijii ^ it, jt {ff} i And whosoever of you is ill or has an ailment in his scalp (necessitating shaving), he must pay a ransom of either fasting or giving charity or offering a sacrifice.} and, A J i oA»k C -L-j* cn iy: i...for its expiation feed ten of the poor, on a scale of the average of that with which you feed your own families, or clothe them, or free a slave.} All of these Ayat offer a choice, just as the Ayah above. At-Tabari 10:263. At-Tabari 10 :262-263

As for Allah's statement, ior be exiled from the land.) some said that it means, he is actively pursued until he is captured, and thus receives his prescribed punishment, or otherwise he escapes from the land of Islam, as Ibn Jarir recorded from Ibn 'Abbas, Anas bin Malik, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabl* bin Anas, Az-Zuhri, Al- Layth bin Sa'd and Malik bin Anas. Some said that the Ayah means these people are expelled to another land, or to another state by the Muslims authorities . Said bin Jubayr, Abu Ash- Sha'tha', Al-Hasan, Az-Zuhri, Ad-Dahhak and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that he is expelled, but not outside of the land of Islam, while others said that he is to be imprisoned. Allah's statement, -0s\$ \ j gfr j {That is their disgrace in this world, and a great torment is theirs in the Hereafter.) means, the punishment We prescribed, killing these aggressors, crucifying them, cutting off their hands and feet on opposite sides, or expelling them from the land is a disgrace for them among mankind in this life, along with the tremendous torment Allah has prepared for them in the Hereafter. This view supports the opinion that these Ayat were revealed about the idolators. As for Muslims, in his SahUi, Muslim recorded that 'Ubadah bin As-Samit said, "The Messenger of Allah took the same pledge from us that he also took from women: That we do not associate anything with Allah in worship, we do not steal, commit adultery, or kill our children, and that we do not spread falsehood about each other. He said that he who keeps this pledge, then his reward will be with Allah. He who falls into shortcomings and was punished, then this will be his expiation. And those whose errors were covered by Allah, then their matter is for Allah: If He wills, He will punish them and If He wills, He will pardon them."¹²¹ 'Ali narrated that the Messenger of Allah gg said, •*> At-Tabari 10:268-270. 121 Muslim 3:1333.

'*4* C/4. oi J* J-iJi <<! u? wi! jt Q* Iff ^ Lipj Qi- <bl oyLli djil^ Cii JJil jjj >• - " . a * Uf. Jj <. "He who sins in this life and was punished for it, then Allah is far more just than to combine two punishments on His servant. He who commits an error in this life and Allah hides this error and pardons

him, then Allah is far more generous than to punish the servant for something that He has already pardoned .» Recorded by Ahmad, Ibn Majah and At-Tirmidhi who said, “Hasan Gharib.”* 11 Al-Hafiz Ad-Daraqutni was asked about this Hadith, and he said that it was related to the Prophet in some narrations, and it was related to the Companions in others, and that this narration from the Prophet is Sahih.m Ibn Jarir commented on Allah’s statement, iQti 4 #^} iThat is their disgrace in this world,} “Meaning, shame, humiliation, punishment, contempt and torment in this life, before the Hereafter, iand a great torment is theirs in the Hereafter.} if they do not repent from these errors until death overcomes them. In this case, they will be stricken by the punishment that We prescribed for them in this life and the torment that We prepared for them therein, ia great torment} in the Fire ofJahannam.’i3] Ahmad 1 : 159, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi7 :377 , Ibn Majah 2:868. Ad-Daraqun 3 :215. At-Tabari 10:276.

The Punishment of those who Wage War Against Allah and His Messenger is Annulled if They Repent Before their Apprehension Allah said, tExcept for those who (having fed away and then) came back (as Muslims) with repentance before they fall into your power; in that case, know that Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful This Ayah is clear in its indication that it applies to the idolators. As for the Muslims who commit this crime and repent before they are apprehended, the punishment of killing, crucifixion and cutting the limbs will be waved. The practice of the Companions in this regard is that all of the punishments prescribed in this case will be waved, as is apparent from the wording of the Ayah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ash-Shahi said, “Harithah bin Badr At-Tamimi was living in Al-Basrah, and he committed the crime of mischief in the land. So he talked to some men from Quraysh, such as Al-Hasan bin ‘Ali, Ibn ‘Abbas and ‘Abdullah bin JaTar, and they talked to ‘Ali about him so that he would grant him safety, but ‘Ali refused. So Harithah went to Said bin Qays Al-Hamadani who kept him in his house and went to ‘Ali, saying, ‘O Leader of the Faithful! What about those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and cause mischief in the land?’ So he recited the Ayah until he reached, A& at ye kt iExcept for those who (having fled away and them) came back cas Muslims) with repentance before they fall into your power> So ‘Ali wrote a document that granted safety, and Said bin Qays said, This is for Harithah bin Badr.” Ibn Jarir recorded this HadithJ Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Amir Ash-Shahi said, “A man from Murad came to Abu Musa, while he was the governor of Al- Kufah during the reign of ‘Uthman, and said to him after he 111 At-Tabari 10:280.

267Surah 5. Al-Maidah (32 - 34) (Part-6) offered the obligatory prayer, ‘O Abu Musa! I seek your help. I am so-and-so from Murad and I waged war against Allah and His Messenger and caused mischief in the land. I repented before you had any authority over me.’ Abu Musa proclaimed, This is so-and-so, who had waged war against Allah and His Messenger and caused mischief in the land, and he repented before we had authority over him. Therefore, anyone who meets him, should deal with him in a better way. If he is saying the truth, then this is the path of those who say the truth. If he is saying a lie, his sins will destroy him. So the man remained idle for as long as Allah willed, but he later rose against the leaders, and Allah punished him for his sins and he was killed.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Musa bin Ishaq Al-Madani said that ‘Ali Al- Asadi waged war, blocked the roads, shed blood and plundered wealth. The leaders and the people alike, sought to capture him, but they could not do that until he came after he repented, after he heard a man reciting the Ayah, if*#£& >A <0 My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah, verily, Allah forgives all sins. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. So he said to that man, “O servant of Allah! Recite it again.” So he recited it

again, and 'Ali put down his sword and went to Al-Madlnah in repentance, arriving during the night. He washed up and went to the Masjid of the Messenger of Allah and prayed the dawn prayer. He sat next to Abu Hurayrah amidst his companions. In the morning, the people recognized him and went after him. He said, "You have no way against me. I came in repentance before you had any authority over me." Abu Hurayrah said, "He has said the truth," and he held his hand and went to Marwan bin Al-Hakam, who was the governor of Al-Madlnah during the reign of Mu'awiyah. Abu Hurayrah said, "This is 'Ali and he came in repentance and you do not have a way against him, nor can you have him killed." So 'Ali was absolved of punishment and remained on his repentance and went to the sea to perform Jihad in Allah's cause. The Muslims met the Romans in battle, and the

Commanding Taqwa, Wasilah and Jihad Allah commands His faithful servants to fear Him in Taqwa, which if mentioned along with acts of obedience, it means to refrain from the prohibitions and the prohibited matters. Allah said next, i%r*7a is seek the Wasilah to Him ^ Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that Talhah said that 'Ata' said that Ibn 'Abbas said that Wasilah means 'the means of approach'.^ * Mujahid, Abu Wa'il, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, 'Abdullah bin Kathir, As-Suddi, Ibn Zayd and others gave the same meaning for Wasilah. Qatadah said that the Ayah means, "Seek the means of approach to Him by obeying Him and performing the acts that please Him."*21 iThose whom they call upon seek a means of access to their Lord (Allah). [17:57] Wasilah is a means of approach to achieve something, and it is also used to refer to the highest grade in Paradise, and it is the grade of the Messenger of Allah jfe, his residence and the nearest grade in Paradise to Allah's Throne. Al-Bukhari recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah 3fe said, ol liUUI S^paJl ;in> JIS y «yOJl «Whoever, after hearing to the Adhdn says, "O Allah! Lord of this perfect call and of the regular prayer which is going to be established! Grant Muhammad the Wasilah and superiority and send him [on the Day of Judgment] to the praiseworthy station which You have promised him," then intercession from me will be permittedfor him on the Day ofResurrection .»'31 Muslim recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Al-'As said 111 At-Tabari 10:291. 121 At-Tabari 10:291. 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :251

170 Tafsir Ibu Kathir that he heard the Prophet& saying, aju < \jLj> pi ijij u ji* \jijH jjjJi iji> •h^- 'fy uf-r 1 ^ iJj~* t^ji i IjLi i jllp <ii JJ aitX*J| <ie- oL>- <1—— _^J jj! jLi v V* ui jjS\ jl 15&I ill#- t/ow hear the Mu'adlidhin, repeat ivhat he says, and then ask for Saldh (blessing, mercy from Allah) for me. Verily, whoever asks for Saldh for me, then Allah will grant ten Saldh to him. Then, ask for the Wasilah for me, for it is a grade in Paradise that only one servant of Allah deserves, and I hope that I am that servant. Verily, whoever asks (Allah) for Wasilah for me, he will earn the right ofmy intercession .»(11 Allah said, iand strive hard in His cause as much as you can . So that you may be successful. After Allah commanded Muslims to avoid the prohibitions and to work towards obedience, He commanded them to fight against their enemies, the disbelievers and idolators who have deviated from the straight path and abandoned the correct religion. Allah encouraged the believers by reminding them of the unending success and great happiness that He prepared for them for the Day of Resurrection, which will never change or decrease for those who join Jihad in His cause. They will remain in the lofty rooms of Paradise that are safe and beautiful. Those who live in these dwellings will always be comfortable and will never be miserable, living, never dying, and their clothes will never grow thin, nor will their youth ever end. No Amount of Ransom Shall Be Accepted from the Disbelievers on the Day ofthe Judgment

and They Will Remain in the Fire Allah then describes the painful torment and punishment that He has prepared for His disbelieving enemies for the Day Muslim 1 :288.

of Resurrection. Allah said, lx ijilJ 4 U y r' 4>'j* ^4~; I* #-£*!' -jj; <^tit Verify, those zoho disbelieve, if they had all that is in the earth, and as much again thereioith to ransom themselves thereby from the torment on the Day of Resurrection, it zvould never be accepted of them. And theirs would be a painfid torment.£ So if a disbeliever brought the earth's fill of gold, and twice as much as that amount on the Day of Judgment to ransom himself from Allah's torment that has surrounded him, and he is certain that he will suffer from it, it will not be accepted of him. Rather, there is no escaping the torment, and he will not be able to evade or save himself from it. Hence Allah's statement, v'js \$\$\$ <*And theirs would be a painfid torment.} meaning, hurtful, 4®^ Z& ~<h ,4«&U \g£ J iThey will long to get out of the Fire, but never zoill they get out therefrom, and theirs will be a lasting torment.} In another Ayah, Allah said. i)Xr6^^ Cri \ iEveny time they seek to get away therefrom, in anguish, they zoill be driven back therein.} Therefore, they will still long to leave the torment because of the severity and the pain it causes. They will have no way of escaping it. The more the flames lift them to the upper part of Hell, the more the angels of punishment will strike them with iron bars and they will fall down to its depths, 4^ <{And theirs zoill be a lasting torment.} meaning, eternal and everlasting, and they will never be able to depart from it or avoid it. Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah sg said,

: <J>V oo>-j fji£ \yi\ U:*J JUj j0i jif 'r'j'i ?l**i ^jSil 'r l, Si . j* :Jlia 3-i *jU' (Jl * j^3s* 1 jUi -iiJi j*^ iiib. jj idJJS : Jil J^ili man from the people of the Fire will be brought forth and will be asked, 'O son of Adam! How did you find your dwelling?' He will say, 'The worst dwelling.' He will be told, 'Would you ransom yourself with the earth's fill of gold?' He will say, 'Yes, O Lord!' Allah will say to him, 'You have lied. 1 asked you for what is less than that and you did not do it,' and he will be ordered to the Fire . Muslim and An-Nasal' recorded it. f§&&& l&4£ it£4 £U 2§V& ii'j S*i & 4>jj4 ofjV'j oyliji v_L4 ii' y Lv:AJ5 ji= 438. And (as for) the male thief and the female thief, cut off their hands as a recompense for that which both committed, a punishment by way of example from Allah. And Allah is All- Powerful, All-Wise> 439. But whosoever repents after his crime and does righteous good deeds, then verily, Allah will pardon him. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Mercifitl .> 440. Know you not that to Allah (Alone) belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth! He forgives whom He wills and He punishes whom He wills. And Allah is able to do all things.> The Necessity ofCutting ofthe Hand ofthe Thief Allah commands and decrees that the hand of the thief, male or female be cut off. During the time of Jahiliyyah, this was also the punishment for the thief, and Islam upheld this punishment. In Islam, there are several conditions that must * Muslim 4 :2 162 and An-Nasal 6:36.

173Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (38 - 40) (Part-6) be met before this punishment is carried out, as we will come to know, Allah willing. There are other rulings that Islam upheld after modifying these rulings, such as that of blood money for example. When Does Cutting the Hand of the Thief Become Necessary? In is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, 3j—t) 1 s-*i OilJl 3j—i 3jLUL uil aMfly Allah curse the thief who steals an egg and as a result his hand is cut off, and who steals rope and as a result his hand is cut ofjff. [1] Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that 'A'ishah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, <77ie hand of the thief shall be cut off if he steals a quarter ofa Dinar or more.»l2] Muslim recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said that

the Messenger of Allah jg said, «The hand of the thief shall only be cut off if he steals a quarter of a Dinar or more.» This Hadith is the basis of the matter since it specifies (that the least amount of theft that deserves cutting the hand) is a quarter of a Dinar. So this Hadith fixes the value. And saying that it is three Dirhams is not a contradiction. This is because the Dinar in question was equal to twelve Dirhams, so three Dirhams equalled a fourth of a Dinar. So in this way it is possible to harmonize these two views. This opinion was reported from Umar bin Al-Khattab, Thman bin 'Affan, 'Ali bin Abi Talib - 111 Fath Al-Bari 12 :83 , Muslim 3 :1314 121 Fath Al-Bari 12 :99, MusUm 3 :1312. 131 MusUm 3:1313.

174 Tafsir Ibn Kathir may Allah be pleased with them - and it is the view of 'Umar bin 'Abdul-'Aziz, Al-Layth bin Sa'd, Al-Awza'i, and Ash-Shafil and his companions. This is also the view of Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal and Ishaq bin Rahwayh in one of the narrations from him, as well as Abu Thawr, and Dawud bin 'Ali Az-Zahari, may Allah have mercy upon them. As for Imam Abu Hanifah and his students Abu Yusuf, Muhammad and Zufar, along with Sufyan Ath-Thawri, they said that the least amount of theft that deserves cutting off the hand is ten Dirhams, whereas a Dinar was twelve Dirhams at that time. The first ruling is the correct one, that the least amount of theft is one fourth of a Dinar or more. This meager amount was set as the limit for cutting the hand, so that the people would refrain from theft, and this is a wise decision to those who have sound comprehension. Hence Allah's statement, in a recompense for that which both committed, a punishment by way of example from Allah. And Allah is All-Powerful, All-Wise.} This is the prescribed punishment for the evil action they committed, by stealing the property of other people with their hands. Therefore, it is fitting that the tool they used to steal the people's wealth be cut off as punishment from Allah for their error. And Allah is All-Powerful,} in His torment, {All-Wise.} in His commands, what he forbids, what He legislates and what He decrees. Repentance of the Thief is Acceptable Allah said next, 4 r y^-j oj. jJo & 11)6 {But whosoever repents after his crime and does righteous good deeds, then verily, Allah will pardon him. Verily, Allah is Oft-

175 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (38 - 40) (Part-6) Forgiving, Most Merciful. Therefore, whoever repents and goes back to Allah after he commits theft, then Allah will forgive him. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that a woman committed theft during the time of the Messenger of Allah jfe and those from whom she stole brought her and said, "O Allah's Messenger! This woman stole from us." Her people said, "We ransom her." The Messenger of Allah jg said, "Cut off her hand.* They said, "We ransom her with five hundred Dinars." The Prophet sg said, *Cut off her hand.* Her right hand was cut off and the woman asked, "O Messenger of Allah! Is there a chance for me to repent?" He said, «Yes. This day, you are free from your sin just as the day your mother gave birth to you. Allah sent down the verse in Surat Al-Ma'idah, . f - » < /.* • . TA J -Oil iBut whosoever repents after his crime and does righteous good deeds (by obeying Allah), then verily, Allah will pardon him. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This woman was from the tribe of Makhzum. Her story was narrated in the Two Sahihis from Az-Zuhri from 'Urwah from 'A'ishah, The incident caused concern for the Quraysh after she committed the theft during the time of the battle of the Conquest [of Makkah]. They said, "Who can talk to Allah's Messenger jg about her matter?" They then said, "Who dares speak to him about such matters other than Usamah bin Zayd, his loved one." When the woman was brought to

the Messenger of Allah Usamah bin Zayd talked to him about her and the face of the Messenger ;jg changed color (because of anger) and 111 Ahmad 2:177.

176 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir he jg said, "Do you intercede in a punishment prescribed by Allah ?» Usamah said to him, "Ask Allah to forgive me, O Allah's Messenger!" During that night, the Messenger of Allah stood up and gave a speech and praised Allah as He deserves to be praised. He then said, njSj: jli\ ijj— Ijj \\\S '-j* jjS}\ Jllaf U aju ji ii»Jl kSs- .— —»—aj t Ijlj «ui' Jjiiij aThose who were before you were destroyed because when an honorable person among them would steal, they would leave him. But, xohen a weak man among them stole, they implemented the prescribed punishment against him. By Him in Whose Hand is my soul! IfFatimah the daughter ofMuhammad stole, I will have her hand cut off. The Prophet si commanded that the hand of the woman who stole be cut off, and it was cut off. 'A'ishah said, 'Her repentance was sincere afterwards, and she got married and she used to come to me so that I convey her needs to the Messenger of Allah." This is the wording that Muslim collected, and in another narration by Muslim, 'A'ishah said, "She was a woman from Makhzum who used to borrow things and deny that she took them. So the Prophet ordered that her hand be cut off."*2' Allah then said, <tgV6 tit ji 4t P fit iKnow you not that to Allah (Alone) belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth!} He owns eveiything and decides what He wills for it and no one can resist His judgment, 4jjJ fj.^&%&S £ 111 Fath Al-Bari 7:619, Muslim 3 :1315. Muslim 3:1316.

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come to you. They change the words from their places; the\ say, "If you are given this, take it, but if you are not given this, then beware!" And whomsoever Allah wants to put in Fitnah, you can do nothing for him against Allah. Those are the ones ivhose hearts Allah does not ivanl to purify; for them there is a disgrace in this world, and in the Hereafter a great torment.} 442. They (like to) listen to falsehood, to devour Suht. So if they come to you, either judge between them, or turn away from them. Ifyou turn awayfrom them, they cannot hurt you in the least. And ifyou judge, judge with justice between them. Verily, Allah loves those who act justly.} i43. But how do they come to you for a decision rohile they have the Tawrdh, in which is the decision of Allah; yet even after that they turn axvay. For they are not believers.} 444. Verily, We did send down the Tawrdh, therein ivas guidance and light, by which the Prophets zuho submitted themselves to Allah's zoill, judged for the Jczos. And the Rabbdniyyiln and the Ahbdr, for vto them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they zvere zoitnesses thereto. Therefore fear not men butfear Me and sell not My verses for a miserable price. And zvhosoever does

not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers.} Do Not Feel Sad Because of the Behavior of the Jews and Hypocrites These honorable Ayat were revealed about those who rush into disbelief, deviating from the obedience of Allah, His Messenger, preferring their opinions and lusts to what Allah has legislated, crying & saying, "We believe" with their mouths but their hearts have no faith.} These people pretend to be faithful with their words, but their hearts are empty from faith, and they are the hypocrites. 4b*1* Si'

1. Atid of the Jews...} the enemies of Islam and its people, they and the hypocrites all, glisten much and eagerly to lies...} and they accept and react to it positively, „ listening to others who have not come to you,} meaning, they listen to some people who do not attend your meetings, O Muhammad. Or, the Ayah might mean, they listen to what you say and convey it to your enemies who do not attend your audience. The Jews Alter and Change the Law, Such As Stoning the Adulterer J-i ot Sjfc} iThcy change the words from their places :} by altering their meanings and knowingly distorting them after they comprehended them, ithey say, "If you are given this, take it, but if you are not given this, then beware!"} It was reported that this part of the Ayah was revealed about some Jews who committed murder and who said to each other, "Let us ask Muhammad to judge between us, and if he decides that we pay the Diah, accept his judgement. If he decides on capital punishment, do not accept his judgement." The correct opinion is that this Ayah was revealed about the two Jews who committed adultery. The Jews changed the law they had in their Book from Allah on the matter of punishment for adultery, from stoning to death, to a hundred flogs and making the offenders ride a donkey facing the back of the donkey. When this incident of adultery occurred after the Hijrah, they said to each other, "Let us go to Muhammad and seek his judgement. If he gives a ruling of flogging, then implement his decision and make it a proof for you with Allah. This way, one of Allah's Prophets will have upheld this ruling amongst you. But if he decides that the punishment should be

180 Tafsir Ibn Kathir stoning to death, then do not accept his decision." There are several Hadeeths mentioning this story. Malik reported that Nafi' said that 'Abdullah bin Umar said, "The Jews came to Allah's Messenger and mentioned that a man and a woman from them committed adultery. Allah's Messenger ﷺ said to them, 'What do you find of the ruling about stoning in the Torah?' They said, 'We only find that they should be exposed and flogged.' 'Abdullah bin Salam said, 'You lie. The Torah mentions stoning, so bring the Torah.' They brought the Torah and opened it but one of them hid the verse about stoning with his hand and recited what is before and after that verse. 'Abdullah bin Salam said to him, 'Remove your hand,' and he removed it, thus uncovering the verse about stoning. So they said, He ('Abdullah bin Salam) has said the truth, O Muhammad! It is the verse about stoning.' The Messenger of Allah ﷺ decided that the adulterers be stoned to death and his command was carried out. I saw that man shading the woman from the stones with his body." Al-Bukhari and Muslim also collected this Hadith and this is the wording collected by Al-Bukhari. In another narration by Al-Bukhari,

the Prophet ﷺ said to the Jews, 'What would you do in this case?' They said, "We would humiliate and expose them." The Prophet ﷺ recited, 'Bring here the Torah and recite it, if you are truthful.' So they brought a man who was blind in one eye and who was respected among them and said to him, "Read (from the Torah)." So he read until he reached a certain verse and then

covered it with his hand. He was told, “Remove your hand,” and it was the verse about stoning. So that man said, “O Muhammad! This is the verse about stoning, and we had hid its knowledge among us.” So the Messenger jg ordered that the two adulterers be stoned, and they were stoned. m Al-Bukhari no . 4556

Muslim recorded that a Jewish man and a Jewish woman were brought before Allah’s Messenger jg because they committed adultery. The Messenger of Allah went to the Jews and asked them, y y. uWhat is the ruling that you find in the Tawrdh for adultery?» They said, “We expose them, carry them (on donkeys) backwards and parade them in public.” The Prophet jg recited; lijBS iffyh iBring here the Tawrdh and recite it, ifyou are truthful> So they brought the Tawrah and read from it until the reader reached the verse about stoning. Then he placed his hand on that verse and read what was before and after it. ‘Abdullah bin Salam, who was with the Messenger of Allah jg, said, “Order him to remove his hand,” and he removed his hand and under it was the verse about stoning. So the Messenger of Allah jg commanded that the adulterers be stoned, and they were stoned. ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar said, “1 was among those who stoned them and I saw the man shading the woman from the stones with his body.” 1 1| Abu Dawud recorded that Ibn ‘Umar said, “Some Jews came to the Messenger of Allah jg and invited him to go to the Quff area. So he went to the house of Al- Midras and they said, ‘O Abu Al-Qasim! A man from us committed adultery with a woman, so decide on their matter.’ They arranged a pillow for the Messenger of Allah jg and he sat on it and said, “Bring the Tawrdh to me . He was brought the Tawrah and he removed the pillow from under him and placed the Tawrah on it, saying, <•/ trust you and He Wlw revealed it to you . He then said, m Muslim 3 :1326.

182 Tafstr Ibn Katlur tBring me your most knowledgeable persons So he was brought a young man... ” and then he mentioned the rest of the story that Malik narrated from Nafi’J These Hadiths state that the Messenger of Allah sg issued a decision that conforms with the ruling in the Tawrah, not to honor the Jews in what they believe in, for the Jews were commanded to follow the Law of Muhammad sg only. Rather, the Prophet did this because Allah commanded him to do so. He asked them about the ruling of stoning in the Tawrah to make them admit to what the Tawrah contains and what they collaborated to hide, deny and exclude from implementing for all that time. They had to admit to what they did, although they did it while having knowledge of the correct ruling. What made them go to the Prophet for judgement in this matter was their lusts and desires, hoping that the Prophet jg would agree with their opinion, not that they believed in the correctness of hisjudgment. This iswhy they said, ilfyou are given this,} referring to flogging, then take it, 4but if you are not given this, then beware!} and do not accept or implement it. Allah said next, ijS iiS Jyi JU djJJI cEXZij\ lili /) - jpjj ^ %% aiif ^p -g. iAnd whomsoever Allah wants to put in Fitnah, you can do nothing for him against Allah . Those are the ones whose hearts Allah does not want to purify; for them there is a disgrace in this world, and in the Hereafter a great torment. Tlthey (like to) listen tofalsehood, to devour Sulit} ‘SuM refers to bribes, as Ibn Mas’ud and others stated.121 The 111 Abu Dawud 4:597. 121 At-Tabari 10:319.

183Surah 5 . Al-Ma'idah (41 - 44) (Part-6 Ayah states that if one is like this, how can Allah cleanse his heart and accept his supplication? Allah said to His Prophet m, £ 4\$ 4So if they come to you ...) so that you judge between them, 4% o\j j' rr* p-4 ^either judge behoeeti them, or turn away from them. If you turn awayfrom them, they cannot hurt you in the least.} meaning, there is no harm if you do not judge

between them. This is because when they came to you to judge between them, they did not seek to follow the truth, but only what conformed to their lusts. We should mention here that Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, and several others said that this part of the Ayah was abrogated by Allah’s statement, & Zj pi44 4And so judge among them by what Allah has revealed.) iArni ifyou judge, judge with justice between them.} and with fairness, even if the Jews were unjust and outcasts from the path of fairness, 4-£ kii iVerily, Allah loves those who act justly.} Chastising the Jews for Their Evil Lusts and Desires, While Praising the Tawrah Allah then chastises the Jews for their false ideas and deviant desires to abandon what they believe is true in their Book, and which they claim is their eternal Law that they are always commanded to adhere to. Yet, they do not adhere to the Tawrah, but they prefer other laws over it, although they believe that these other laws are not correct and do not apply m At-Tabari 10:330-332.

down the Ayat, J' ii' Jy' Hj 2 i>*J^ 4A)id ivhosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,} jii iSuch are the unjust,} and, 4Swc/i are the rebellious .} about two groups among the Jews. During the time of Jahiliyyah, one of them had defeated the other. As a result, they made a treaty that they would pay blood money totaling fifty Wasaq [of gold] (each Wasaq approx. 3 kg) for every dead person from the defeated group killed by the victors, and a hundred Wasaq for every dead person the defeated group killed from the victors. This treaty remained in effect until the Prophet came to Al-Madlnah and both of these groups became subservient under the Prophet sfe. Yet, when the mighty group once suffered a casualty at the hands of the weaker group, the mighty group sent a delegation demanding the hundred Wasaq. The weaker group said, ‘How can two groups who have the same religion, one ancestral lineage and a common land, have a Diah that for some of them is half of that of the others? We only agreed to this because you oppressed us and because we feared you. Now that Muhammad has come, we will not give you what you asked.’ So war was almost rekindled between them, but they agreed to seek Muhammad’s judgement in their dispute. The mighty group among them said [among themselves], ‘By Allah! Muhammad will never give you double the Diah that you pay to them compared to what they pay to you. They have said the truth anyway, for they only gave us this amount because we oppressed and overpowered them. Therefore, send someone to Muhammad who will sense what his judgement will be. If he agrees to give you what you demand, accept his judgment, and if he does not give you what you seek, do not refer to him for judgement.’ So they sent some hypocrites to the Messenger of Allah jg to try and find out the Messenger’s judgement. When they came to the Messenger sg, Allah informed him of their

matter and of their plot. Allah sent down, iO Messenger! Let not those who hurry to fall into disbelief grieve you,) until, iSuch are the rebellious.) By Allah! It is because of their problem that Allah sent down these verses and it is they whom Allah meant.” 1" Abu Dawud collected a similar narration for this HadlthP Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah in Surat Al-Ma'idah, }' fr* r &&¥ ieither judge behoeen them, or turn awayfrom them...) until, iThose who act justly.) was revealed concerning the problem of blood money between Bani An-Nadir and Bani Qurayzah. The dead of Bani An-Nadlr were being honored more and they received the full amount of Diah, while Qurayzah received half the Diah for their dead. So they referred to the Messenger of Allah jfc for judgement and Allah sent down these verses about them. The Messenger of Allah ^ compelled them to adhere to the true judgement in this matter and made the Diah the same for both groups and Allah

knows best about that matter.”¹³¹ Ahmad, Abu Dawud and An-Nasā¹⁴¹ also recorded this Hadith from Abu Ishaq. Al-‘Awfi and ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that these Ayat were revealed about the two Jews who committed adultery, and we mentioned the Hadiths about this story before. It appears that both of these were the reasons behind revealing these Ayat, and Allah knows best. This is why Allah said afterwards, Ahmad 1 :246. I2 ' Abu Dawud 4 :7 At-Jabari 10:326. Ahmad 1 :363 , Abu Dawud 4:16 and An-Nasā 8:19.

iopii o' '<tt r#<5^ \$Aiid We ordained therein for them: Life for life, eye for eye*? until the end of the Ayah, which strengthens the opinion that

the story of the Dīyah was behind revealing the Ayat as we

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1509–1537]

explained above. Allah knows best. Allah said, ^And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers .? Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib, Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman, Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Mijlaz, Abu Raja’ Al-‘Utaridi, ‘Ikrimah, ‘Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others said that this Ayah was revealed about the People of the Book.' ' Al-Hasan Al- Basri added that this Ayah also applies to us . ¹²¹ ‘Abdur- Razzaq said that Ath-Thawri said that Mansur said that Ibrahim said that these Ayat, “Were revealed about the Children of Israel, and Allah accepted them for this Ummah.” Ibn Jarir recorded this statement.³ ' ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah also stated that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statement, iAnd whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,\$ “Whoever rejects what Allah has revealed, will have committed Kufr, and whoever accepts what Allah has revealed, but did not rule by it, is a Zalim (unjust) and a Fasiq (rebellious) and a sinner.” Ibn Jarir recorded this statement.⁴ ' ‘Abdur-Razzaq said, “Ma’mar narrated to us that Tawus said that Ibn ‘Abbas was asked about Allah’s statement, \$& 111 At-Tabari 10:347-357. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 10:357. ¹³¹ At-Tabari 10:356. (4> At-Tabari 4:597.

4And whosoever does not judge. He said, “It is an act of Kufr.’ Ibn Tawus added, It is not like those who disbelieve in Allah, His angels. His Books and His Messengers.’ Ath-Thawri narrated that Ibn Jurayj said that ‘Ata’ said, There is Kufr and Kufr less than Kufr, Zulm and Zulm less than Zulm, Fisq and Fisq less than Fisq.”^ Waki’ said that Said Al-Makki said that Tawus said that, 4^fs&S\ pi ibjti ill \$ il, Xfe JJX) 4And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers,) This is not the Kufr that annuls one’s religion. o% j\ 'Q^ Gg) (*^==u: J X •* XxX XX IsXh pi iujti& ti 445. And We ordained therein for them "Life for life, eye for eye, nose for nose, ear for ear, tooth for tooth, and wounds equal for equal.” But if anyone remits the retaliation by way of clemency, it shall be for him an expiation. And whosoever does not judge by that which Allah has revealed, such are the unjust.) This Ayah also chastises and criticizes the Jews because in the Tawrah, they have the law of a life for a life. Yet, they defied this ruling by transgression and rebellion. They used to apply this ruling when a person from Bani An-Nadlir was killed by a Qurayzah person, but this was not the case when the opposite occurred. Rather, they would revert to Dīyah in this case. They also defied the ruling in the Tawrah to stone the adulterer and instead came up with their own form of punishment, flogging, humiliation and parading them in public. This is why Allah said in the previous Ayah, ilfgs pi &&X iX) 4And

whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, ‘Abdur-Razzaq 1 :191 , At-Jabari 4 :595. At-Tabari 10:355.

189enroll 5. Al-Ma'idah (45) (Part-6) such are the disbelievers. because they rejected Allah's command with full intention and with transgression and rebellion. In this Ayah, Allah said, isuch are the unjust because they did not exact the oppressed his due rights from the oppressor in a matter which Allah ordered that all be treated equally and fairly. Instead, they defied that command, committed injustice and transgressed against each other. A Man is Killed for a Woman Whom He Kills Imam Abu Nasr bin As-Sabbagh stated in his book, Ash- Shamil, that the scholars agree that this Ayah [5:45] should be implemented, and the Imams agree that the man is killed for a woman whom he kills, according to the general indications of this Ayah. A Hadith that An-Nasab recorded states that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) had this statement written in the book that he gave ‘Amr bin Hazm, nThe man is killed for the woman (whom he kills). In another Hadith, the Messenger (ﷺ) said, «Muslims are equal regarding the sanctity of their blood.”² This is also the opinion of the majority of the scholars. What further supports what Ibn As-Sabbagh said is the Hadith that Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “Ar-Rabī‘ (his aunt) broke the tooth of a girl, and the relatives of Ar-Rabī‘ requested the girl's relatives to forgive (the offender), but they refused. So, they went to the Prophet (ﷺ) who ordered them to bring about retaliation. Anas bin An-Nadr, her brother, asked, ‘O Allah's Messenger! Will the tooth of Ar- Rabī‘ be broken?’ The Messenger of Allah said, ‘O Anas! The Book of Allah prescribes retaliation.’ Anas said, *No, by Him Who has sent you with the Truth, her tooth will not be broken.’ I 1 ’ An-Nasab 8:58. 121 Ibn Majah 2:895.

190 Tafsir Ibn Katir Later the relatives of the girl agreed to forgive Ar-Rabī‘ and forfeit their right to retaliation. The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, «s^S/ .dll ^s. j, it _jj j* aJJI jLp v. jl? “There are some of Allah's servants who, if they take an oath by Allah, Allah fulfills . »”[1 It was recorded in the Two Sahihsf^ Retaliation for Wounds Allah said, \$and wounds equal for equal. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Life for life, an eye for an eye, a nose, if cut off, for a nose, a tooth broken for a tooth and wounds equal for wound.”¹³ ' The free Muslims, men and women, are equal in this matter. And their slaves, male and female, are equal in this matter. And this ruling is the same regarding intentional murder and lesser offenses, as Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded. An Important Ruling The retaliation for wounds should not be implemented until the wounds of the victim heal. If retaliation occurs before the wound heals, and then the wound becomes aggravated, the victim will have no additional rights in this case. The proof for this ruling is what Imam Ahmad narrated from ‘Amr bin Shu'ayb, from his father, from his grandfather that a man once stabbed another man in his leg using a horn. The victim came to the Prophet (ﷺ) asking for retaliation, and the Prophet (ﷺ) said, “Not until you healj The man again came to the Prophet (ﷺ) and asked for equality in retaliation and the Prophet (ﷺ) allowed him that. Later on, Ahmad 3:167. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :124 , Muslim 3 :1302 At-Tabari 10:360.

that man said, “O Messenger of Allah! I limp now.” Messenger (ﷺ) said, Jfaj <uit il-Ujli t The </ had asked you to zvait, but you disobeyed me. Therefore, Allah cast you away and your limp has no compensation .» Afterwards, the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) forbade that the wound be retaliated for until the wound of the victim heals. If the victim is allowed to retaliate for his wound caused by the aggressor and the aggressor dies as a result, there is no compensation in this case, according to the

majority of the Companions and their followers. The Pardon is Expiation for Such Offenses Allah said, f+i . * ^S} iBut if anyone remits the retaliation by way of chanty, it shall befor him an expiation . } ‘ALi bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented that 4-*. iBut if anyone remits the retaliation by way of charity} means; “If one pardons by way of charity, it will result in expiation for the aggressor and reward for the victim.” Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that ‘Ata’ bin As-Sa’ib said that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, ‘He who pardons the retaliation by way of charity, it will be an expiation for the aggressor and a reward for the victim with Allah.”¹³¹ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement. Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that Allah’s statement, 4/3 »jUg-s» j+s . * j—9^ iBut if anyone remits the retaliation by way of charity, it shall befor him an expiation,} “For the victim.” This is also the opinion of Al-Hasan Al- Basri, Ibrahim An-Nakha! and Abu Ishaq Al-Hamdani. 111 Ahmad 2:217. 121 At-Tabari 10:367. 131 At-Tabari 10:326.

192 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Imam Ahmad recorded that Tjbadah bin As-Samit said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah saying, Sr— a* l*” ^ V! 1 14; jjLiils jjLi; U jîj Jii ‘Any man who suffers a wound on his body and forfeits his right of retalia- tion as way of charity, then Allah will pardon him that which is similar to what heforfeited.^ An-Nasal*2 and Ibn Jarir recorded this Hadith. Allah’s statement, jyi \1> j»A jU 4And whosoever does not judge by that which Allah has revealed, such are the unjust re^ == ^^ ==^====^====^m (IwLJlS.^v,ayjjyi)(JJJ> J^s£ ‘J I jtiJJs j ittij -j.’ al I ^niLljjli <Ujl <bjuw • -jyLfcJ u « t£ y* X^^ y ^ ^ , rfy^ yx (*-**|>W J AliiJ^jUj lU. 0 Ail^i==il«i*Jlil ^ *il 1 ji-S—uli AU’OijjOijycU jîjTjîi jea0 <*-** *-i/<r> ci^iy All’; 1 < * - » *-t y<j> ri 1 aJL^jLI Earlier we mentioned the statements of ‘Ata’ and Tawus that there is Kufrand lesser Kufr, injustice and lesser injustice and Fisq and lesser Fisq. iy^)^ o; i* Q lij-i ^ jj Jfo> r?^ * c£ J*^ ‘\$*-> Akf.jyj JAKj iv>yji ,>, U *>>j tfoi * - 4 ‘ ‘ ‘ ‘ . *-T 1 446. And in their footsteps, We sent ‘Isa, son of Maryam, *** Ahmad 5:316. An-Nasat in Al-Kubra 6:335 and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari 10:364. The meaning of this Hdlth is supported by other texts

confirming the Tawrah that had come before him, and We gave him the Injil, in which was guidance and light and confirmation of the Tawrah that had come before it, a guidance 'and an admonition for those who have Taqwa.} 447. Let the people of the Injil judge by what Allah has revealed therein. And whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the rebellious. Allah Mentions ‘Isa and Praises the Injil Allah said, 4and We sent...} meaning, We sent 4in their footsteps} meaning the Prophets of the Children of Israel, Oi A-i-j os LJ ^ J-u*} 4‘Isa, son of Maryam, confirming the Tawrah that had come before him,} meaning, he believed in it and ruled by it. jt /I 4and We gave him the Injil, in which was guidance and light} a guidance that directs to the truth and a light that removes the doubts and solves disputes, 4and confirmation of the Tawrah that had come before it,} meaning, he adhered to the Tawrah, except for the few instances that clarified the truth where the Children of Israel differed. Allah states in another Ayah that Isa said to the Children of Israel, 4 ...and to make lawful to you part of what was forbidden to you.} So the scholars say that the Injil abrogated some of the

295Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) Ayah was revealed about the Christians, and this is evident from the context of the Ayah. LfeJ, jjShJu i_~ jSJ i //• #5® &» ;k‘3 V^= s»3i Si &Z — p, il£-p S; M£ Iis ,U;T^ jis -fc & J&i ^ST U S •-'i-U ^^ =a.U>J «LI Jti ill J_/_1 Uj >u5”” t*j Ll^jw iit ij* (3 |5cli ijJy4 iyi ii' S6 —£)j~*i o' 5*j ojv. cA ob fri11 ois^j (T±fi & ^j3i tS-^ OJ £r^ 44S. And We /woe sent down to you the Book (this Qur'an) in truth, confirming the Scripture that came before it and Muhayminan over

it (old Scriptures). So judge between them by what Allah has revealed, and follow not their vain desires, diverging away from the truth that has come to you. To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way. If Allah willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you; so compete in good deeds. The return of you (all) is to Allah; then He will inform you about that in which you used to differ 449. And so judge between them by what Allah has revealed and follow not their vain desires, but beware of them lest they turn you far away from some of that which Allah has sent down to you. And if they turn away, then know that Allah's will is to punish them for some sins of theirs. And truly, most men are rebellious 450. Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance? And who is better in judgement than Allah for a people who have firm faith? Praising the Qur'an; the Command to Refer to the Qur'an for Judgment Allah mentioned the Tawrah that He sent down to His Prophet Musa, the one whom He spoke directly to, praising it, commanding that it should be implemented, before it was

196 Tafsir Ibn Kathir abrogated. Allah then mentioned the Injil, praised it and commanded its people to adhere to it and follow it, as we stated. He next mentioned the Glorious Qur'an that He sent down to His honorable servant and Messenger. Allah said, *And We have sent down to you the Book in truth... meaning, with the truth that, no doubt, is coming from Allah, confirming the Scripture that came before it meaning, the Divinely Revealed Books that praised the Qur'an and mentioned that it would be sent down from Allah to His servant and Messenger Muhammad* *sg. The Qur'an was revealed as was foretold in the previous Scriptures. This fact increased faith in the previous Scriptures for the sincere who have knowledge of these Scriptures, those who adhered to Allah's commands and Laws and believed in His Messengers. Allah said, "Believe in it or do not believe (in it) . Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration." And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled meaning that they say, the promise of our Lord, concerning the coming of Muhammad by the words of His previous Messengers, will certainly be fulfilled. Allah's statement, and Muhammad over it means entrusted over it, according to Sufyan Ath-Thawri who narrated it from Abu Ishaq from At-Tamimi from Ibn 'Abbas . m Af-Tabari 10:378.*

197 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Muhammad is, 'the Trustworthy'. Allah says that the Qur'an is trustworthy over every Divine Book that preceded it." 111 This was reported from 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Muhammad bin KaT), 'Atiyyah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd . 121 Ibn Jarir said, "The Qur'an is trustworthy over the Books that preceded it. Therefore, whatever in these previous Books conforms to the Qur'an is true, and whatever disagrees with the Qur'an is false." Al-Walibi said that Ibn 'Abbas said that Muhammad means, 'Witness'. 13 ' Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi said the same. Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said that Muhammad means, 'dominant over the previous Scriptures'. 41 These meanings are similar, as the word Muhammad includes them all. Consequently, the Qur'an is trustworthy, a witness, and dominant over every Scripture that preceded it. This Glorious Book, which Allah revealed as the Last and Final Book, is the most encompassing, glorious and perfect Book of all times. The Qur'an includes all the good aspects of previous Scriptures and even more, which no previous Scripture ever contained. This is why Allah made it trustworthy, a witness and dominant over all Scriptures. Allah promised that He will protect the Qur'an and swore by His Most Honorable Self, /i

'Tilt iVerily, We, it is We Who have sent down the Dhikr and surely, We will guard it (from corruption).} Allah said, iSo judge between them by what Allah has revealed.} The Ayah commands: O Muhammad! Rule between the people, Arabs and non-Arabs, lettered and unlettered, by what Allah has revealed to you in this Glorious Book and what it At-Tabari 10:379. '2| At-Tabari 10:377-380. At-Tabari 10:377. At-Tabari 10:379.

approves of for you from the Law of the previous Prophets, as Ibn Jarir said. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Prophet had the choice to judge between them or to turn away from them and refer them to their own Law. Then this Ayah was revealed, \$j} iSo judge between them by what Allah has revealed, and follow not their vain desires...} and he was commanded to judge between them by our Book."121 Allah's statement iand follow not their vain desires. . .} This means the ideas they promote, because of which they turned away from what Allah revealed to His Messengers. This is why Allah said, i'&X Si Q3 -Tj} iAnd follow not their vain desires, diverging away from the truth that has come to you.} The Ayah commands: Do not diverge from the truth that Allah has ordained for you, to the vain desires of these miserable, ignorant people. Allah's statement, CQ;j j£* £££.p} 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law and a clear way.} itv* P*mp> 4To each among you, We have prescribed a law} Shir'at meaning, a clear path, as Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn 'Abbas.131 4'^3 iif ;vl%} At-Tabari 10:382. A^-Jabari 10:332. 131 At-Tabari 10:387.

199Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) 41/Allah willed, He would have made you one nation. This is a general proclamation to all nations informing them of Allah's mighty ability. If Allah wills, He would make all mankind follow one religion and one Law, that would never be abrogated. Allah decided that every Prophet would have his own distinct law that is later abrogated partially or totally with the law of a latter Prophet. Later on, all previous laws were abrogated by the Law that Allah sent with Muhammad gj, His servant and Messenger, whom Allah sent to the people of earth as the Final Prophet. Allah said, z 40a js; £14^3 iii •);} 41/Allah willed, He would have made you one nation, but that (He) may test you in what He has given you This Ayah means, Allah has instituted different laws to test His servants' obedience to what He legislates for them, thus, He rewards or punishes them according to their actions and what they intend. 'Abdullah bin Kathlr said that the Ayah, 4In what He has given you.} means, of the Book. Next, Allah encouraged rushing to perform good deeds, <fso strive as in a race in good deeds.} which are obedience to Allah, following His Law that abrogated the laws that came before it, and believing in His Book, the Qur'an, which is the Final Book that He revealed. Allah said next, 4The return o/you (all) is to Allah;} Therefore, O people, your return and final destination is to Allah on the Day of Resurrection, 4then He will inform you about that in which you used to differ.} Allah will inform you about the truth in which you used to

201Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (48 - 50) (Part-6) Therefore, the majority of humans are disobedient to their Lord, defiant of the truth and deviate away from it. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd most people will not believe even if you desire it eagerly,} and, tjffi 0* oft iAnd if you obey most of those on the earth they will mislead you far away from Allah's path.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Ka*b bin Asad, Ibn Saluba, 'Abdullah bin Surya and Shas bin Qays said to each other, 'Let us go to Muhammad to try and misguide him from his religion.' So they went to the Prophet and said, 'O Muhammad! You know that we are the scholars, noblemen and chiefs of the Jews. If we follow you, the

Jews will follow suit and will not contradict us. But, there is enmity between us and some of our people, so we will refer to you for judgement in this matter, and you should rule in our favor against them and we will believe in you.' The Messenger of Allah ﷺ refused the offer and Allah sent down these Ayat about them, {And so judge between them by what Allah has revealed and follow not their vain desires, but beware of them lest they turn you far away from some of that which Allah has sent down to you.} until, {for a people who have firm faith.}" Ibn Jarir¹¹¹ and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this Hadith. Allah continues, {O Messenger of Allah, I have revealed to you what I have revealed to Moses, that you should be a witness for the people.} At-Tabari 10:393.

4Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance? And who is better in judgement than Allah for a people who have firm faith?} Allah criticizes those who ignore Allah's commandments, which include every type of righteous good thing and prohibit every type of evil, but they refer instead to opinions, desires and customs that people themselves invented, all of which have no basis in Allah's religion. During the time of Jahiliyyah, the people used to abide by the misguidance and ignorance that they invented by sheer opinion and lusts. The Tatar (Mongols) abided by the law that they inherited from their king Genghis Khan who wrote Al-Yasiq, for them. This book contains some rulings that were derived from various religions, such as Judaism, Christianity and Islam. Many of these rulings were derived from his own opinion and desires. Later on, these rulings became the followed law among his children, preferring them to the Law of the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger ﷺ. Therefore, whoever does this, he is a disbeliever who deserves to be fought against, until he reverts to Allah's and His Messenger's decisions, so that no law, minor or major, is referred to except by His Law. Allah said, 4Do they then seek the judgement of (the days of) ignorance?} meaning, they desire and want this and ignore Allah's judgement, {And who is better in judgement than Allah for a people who have firm faith?} Who is more just in decision than Allah for those who comprehend Allah's Law, believe in Him, who are certain that Allah is the best among those who give decisions and that He is more merciful with His creation than the mother with her own child? Allah has perfect knowledge of everything, is able to do all things, and He is just in all matters. Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said, {I

never sum up the days of ignorance and he who seeks to shed the blood of a person without justification.} Al-Bukhari recorded Abu Al-Yaman narrating a similar Hadith, with some addition., 2 ' > & i V ip: 3ji < & ipjl IP> f \f. >?,r .4^ . « * ... • j! rtH .**? rbt iri o?~. fji)l rfJLJj V ill J* >> < ^ f" !>>• 4 itjl' >Aa .1 ? 1 4' . . * > f*J* Ojlji (»Jj jt ol ill jJiTj b.l^~l a8EJ <£•: yt JJs -4 i&j t& 1^5 ..** & ^ ,i ^it ijipti ps& iix ' ^sa#^ j£. it i£2 yt ^52 . O yow who believe! Do not take friends from the Jews and the Christians, as they are but friends of each other. And if any among you befriends them, then surely, he is one of them. Verily, Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers.) 52 . And you see those in whose hearts there is a disease, they hurry to their friendship, saying: "We fear lest some misfortune or a disaster may befall us." Perhaps Allah may bring a victory or a decision according to His will. Then they will become 111 At-Tabarani 10:374. 121 FathAl-Bari 12:219.

3^5 ijlic; -j IS \$\$} 40 you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as friends, K' ' Allah said, 4And you see those in whose hearts there is a disease...} A disease of doubt, hesitation and hypocrisy.

4ptf 4they hurry to theirfriendship,} meaning, they rush to offer them their friendship and allegiances in secret and in public, 4saying : "We fear lest some misfortune of a disaster may befall us."} They thus offer this excuse for their friendship and allegiances to the disbelievers, saying that they fear that the disbelievers might defeat the Muslims, so they want to be in favor with the Jews and Christians, to use this favor for their benefit in that eventuality! Allah replied, jfc jl iif 4Perhaps Allah may bring a victory...} referring to the conquering ofMakkah, according to As-Suddi.'2 4or a decision according to His will} requiring the Jews and Christians to pay the Jizyah, as As-Suddi stated, 4^4 4Then they will become} meaning, the hypocrites who gave their friendship to the Jews and Christians, will become, 'j £&4 4for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves} of allegiances, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1156. At-Jabari 10:405.

iregretful for their friendship with the Jews and Christians which did not benefit them or protect them from any harm. Rather, it was nothing but harm, as Allah exposed their true reality to His faithful servants in this life, although they tried to conceal it. When the signs that exposed their hypocrisy were compiled against them, their matter became clear to Allah's faithful servants. So the believers were amazed at these hypocrites who pretended to be believers, swearing to their faithfulness, yet their claims were all lies and deceit. This is why Allah said, ifckr X iAnd those who believe ivill say, "Are these the men ivto swore their strongest oaths by Allah that they were with you?" All that they did has been in vain, and they have become the losers / yff <•' * *+ A? <•'< / {'w / ;>// * V jjjt ^2' i (*i*£ ^ *£ti u* It*-* w/jM / * <i i* P «*,** ® ^ i ^ ^ / * , // « f •li ,>* J -up Vj au* J-u- j Jfc *£*i* ^ Ch[luij ^ ^ f£C U\$J \$£»&& oZ 454. O you who believe! Whoeverfrom among you turns back from his religion (Islam), Allah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him; humble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers, fighting in the way ofAllah, and never fearing the blame of the blamers. That is the grace of Allah which He bestows on whom He wills. And Allah is All- Sufficientfor His creatures' needs, All-Knower.> 455. Verily, your Protector is Allah, His Messenger, and the believers, those who perform the Saldh, and give Zakdh, and they bow down 456. And whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who have believed, as protectors, then the party ofAllah will be the victorious.\$

207Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (54 - 56) (Part-6) Threatening to Replace the Believers With Another People ifThey Revert from Islam Allah emphasizes His mighty ability and states that whoever reverts from supporting His religion and establishing His Law, then Allah will replace them with whomever is better, mightier and more righteous in Allah's religion and Law. Allah said in other Ayat, ^ ^ 'jip iAnd if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} and. 2A 45 di j #} 4Do you not see that Allah has created the heavens and the earth with truth? IfHe will, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation! And for Alldh that is not hard or difficult.>(14 : 19-20]. Verily this is not difficult or hard on Allah. Allah said here, i#ti VX '\$ \$£> 40 you who believe! Whoeverfrom among you turns backfrom his religion...} and turns back from the truth to falsehood, from now until the commencement of the Last Hour. Allah said next. ihumble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers.} These are the qualities of perfect believers, as they are humble with their believing brothers and allies, stem with their enemies and adversaries. In another Ayah, Allah said. ,iZL& %& ZJ} iMuhammad is the Messenger of Alldh. And those who are with him are severe

against disbelievers, and merciful among themselves.} The Prophet ﷺ is described as the smiling fighter, smiling to his allies and fighting his enemies. Allah's statement,

ilfj Stfm % if 4 $\text{\$} > * \text{\pounds}$.} iFighting in the way of Allah, and never fearing the blame of the btamers.} Nothing prevents them from obeying Allah, establishing His Law, fighting His enemies, enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. Certainly, nothing prevents them from taking this path, neither someone who seeks to hinder them, nor one who blames or chastises them. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr said, "My Khalil (intimate friend, the Messenger) has commanded me to do seven deeds. He commanded me to love the poor and to be close to them. He commanded me to look at those who are less than me and not those who are above me. He commanded me to keep the relations of the womb, even if they cut it. He commanded me not to ask anyone for anything, to say the truth even if it was bitter, and to not fear the blame of anyone for the sake of Allah. He commanded me to often repeat, 'La hawla wa la quwwata ilia biUah (There is no strength or power except from Allah)', for these words are from a treasure under the Throne (of Allah)." 1 11 It is confirmed in the Sahih; * < -' (J-L jl $\text{\pounds}$ *B «The believer is not required to humiliate himselfJ He sg was asked; "How does one humiliate himself, O Messenger ofAllah?" So he sg replied; «He takes on tests that he cannot bear.»™ / + •» •i* > "V ic ftjJi iThat is the grace of Allah which He bestows on whom He wills.} meaning, those who have these qualities, acquired it by Allah's bounty and favor and because He granted them these qualities. Ahmad 5 :405 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :531 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1332 Ahmad 5 :159.

4.5-4-* - ^6 * $\text{\$}$ >} iAtid Allah is All-Sufficient for His creatures' needs, All- Knower, $\text{\$}$ > His favor is ever extending, and He has perfect knowledge of those who deserve or do not deserve His favor and bounty. Allah's statement, iVerily, your Protector is Allah, His Messenger, and the believers . ..} means, the Jews Eire not your friends. Rather, your allegiance is to Allah, His Messenger and the faithful believers. 4WS& ytrrf SfS '44 ithose who perform lire Saldh, and give the Zakdh ...} referring to the believers who have these qualities and establish the prayer, which is one of the most important pillsirs of Islam, for it includes worshipping Allah alone without partners. They pay Zakdh, which is the right of the creation and a type of help extended to the needy and the poor. As for Allah's statement, iand they bow down,} some people thought that they give the Zakdh while bowing down. If this were the case, then paying the Zakdh while bowing would be the best form of giving Zakdh. No scholar from whom religious rulings Eire tEiken says this, as much as we know. Therefore, 4&i iand they bow down,} means, they attend the prayer in congregation in Allah's Masjids and spend by way of charity on the vEirious needs ofMuslims. Allah said; }Atid whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who have believed, as protectors, then the party of Allah will be the victorious.}

Kfi&ifc ' 'A ^ similarly Allah said; UJJbj*1*) JJ»^0 lilj^_j J^iy 0 <^riliV ill! ll^U *" $\text{\pounds}$ V "j-,Jr^P (iji ill -'"^jl -r^t P, P^S-vt. 6j »&fpEpA\$ k -& &Pa*^ J'-" S* ^4>% '^Jiijto ;1 r^ ,:^ liilluii^ilu^ f\$| LillLtd . 1111:6(22 ^ ^ J A'Msr^AirL &'ir. -irrn^r - ,yJ^iCi ^ f 7^ -* t-'r-'u" Ivrm -r > Z''.'&\ *&&> * $\text{\pounds}$ &si r**\$J ->-\$P=*o Ep v,<., -s t, jUVi^^5jiliw5>I^JliJoiJjl .,1 >{. ^ "<., . , , " , (^c-cii ,r>gj ouL>- p; it cp.\ «A//d/i has decreed: wJjT-'^(MT^ff -'i^E Messengers who shall be 4jilUui>li— i^uyjjlIDS //jg victorious." Verily, \$ ^ ,s All-Powerful, «it $\text{\pounds}$ > cyki VI ,it 4>> Ji\$! k (^Jj 4@^ $\text{\pounds}$ it3* Si II ^ Afwfohiu. You zed/ not find any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even though they were their fathers or their sons or their brothers or their kindred

(people). For such He has written faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with a Ruh (proof) from Himself. And He will admit them to Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow to dwell therein (forever). Allah is pleased with them, and they with Him. They are the party of Allah. Verily, it is the party of Allah that will be the successful.} Therefore, those who accept the allegiance of Allah - His Messenger and the faithful believers - will gain success in this life and the Hereafter. Hence Allah's statement here, ZM % ip: <d5 fcZ^ &; p> iAnd whosoever takes Allah, His Messenger, and those who

have believed, as protectors, then the party of Allah will be the victorious.} M &i CjM & a; <2:& 13 WsS -5 Ip:\$ % fiS u/ili juSSif JJ »S|3 ^ * & \$5 bj \$35 * -»J» >-iA 457. O you who believe! Do not take as friends those who take your religion for a mockery and fun from those who received the Scriptures before you, and (nor) the disbelievers; and have Taqwa of Allah if you indeed are true believers.} 458. And when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery and fun; that is because they are a people who understand not.} The Prohibition of Being Loyal Friends with Disbelievers This Ayah discourages and forbids taking the enemies of Islam and its people, such as the People of the Book and the polytheists, as friends. These disbelievers mock the most important acts that any person could ever perform, the honorable, pure acts of Islam which include all types of good for this life and the Hereafter. They mock such acts and make them the subject of jest and play, because this is what these acts represent in their misguided minds and cold hearts. Allah said; i'M & ifrom those who received the Scriptures before you and (nor) the disbelievers. . .} This is to clarify the particular category (of disbelievers). As Allah said, 4/i 4So shun the evil of the idols...} [22:30] So some recited it "Kuff&ri", making it an object of the preposition, and others recited it "Kuffara", making it a predicate noun; M par ijji & g;& 'S IAS#

iTake not as friends those who take your religion for a mockery and fun from those who received the Scriptures before you . . .) with the meaning of "nor". inor the disbelievers as friends That is, do not take these people nor those people as friends. The meaning here of "Kuffar" [disbelievers] is idolators. Similarly, Ibn Jarir recorded that in the recitation of Ibn Mas'ud [in place of "Kuffar" he recited it: "and those who commit Shirk . Allah's statement, (o&J* 4 Si' ffii) iAnd have Taqwa of Allah if you indeed are true believers means, fear Allah and do not take the enemies of you and your religion as friends, if you believe in Allah's Law and religion that these people mocked and jested about. Allah said in another Ayah, ^ -li > Jji iif iuj JS iLet not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that, will never be helped by Allah in any way, except if you indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself, and to Allah is the final return.) The Disbelievers Mock the Prayer and the Adhan Allah said, jjUJt jj Y>\}) iAnd when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery and fun;) When you proclaim the Adhan for the prayer, which is the best action there is, for those who have sound minds and good m At-Tabari 10:430.

comprehension, it they take it...) also,)as a mockery and fun; tltat is because they are a people who understand not.) the acts of worship and Allah's Law. These are the characteristics of the followers of Shaytan who, lA >Jj 'yii jliVl Iil» Jr lili Jlil i jk> #5 -A fJ uj #i tis :i# ijii3 ^Jl>w .li i«IlJi J>-j liji «W? ten file call for prayer is made, Shaytan takes to his heels passing wind so that he may not hear the Adhan . When the call is finished he comes back, and when the Iqdmah is pronounced, Shaytan again takes to his heels. When the Iqdmah is finished he comes back again and tries to interfere with the

person and his thoughts and to say, 'Remember this and that,' which he has not thought of before the prayer, until the praying person forgets how much he has prayed. If anyone of you does not remember, then he should perform two prostrations before pronouncing the Salami This Hadith is agreed upon. Az-Zuhri said, "Allah mentioned the Adhan in His Book, J UJj tjjr* UjJid J) iAnd when you proclaim the call for the Saldh, they take it (but) as a mockery and fun; that is because they are a people who understand not.)" Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement.¹² ' \$j&1 j'j J>' Uj jyl ~C.j jit, d«U o' VI iL 0_,. is ji Al-Bukhari nos. 608, 1222, 1231 and Muslim 1 :291 , 398. '2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 4 : 1 164

(*r* ^ -T-^J 4ii\ j* A»\ x^ . i£# dUi ^La \$^j\ J* Ji •jj'i fSj'X- \ij ^V,J^~UI *)»- jt jjj ts3 OydJ' Ju£.j OjSl fS «*##& (X c#% 4 £> S pi; ^it ijSis i; dir. H>x£)" (H -rt VP *y^ £ S^4 '=Xb\ t^J=X) o'jjJ'j ^ oj*a4 !\$? c^g^jf ^ jU5^ #315 ^59. Say: "O People of the Scripture! Do you criticize us for no other reason than that we believe in AllaJt, and in what has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us), and that most ofyou are rebellious?"} 460. Say: "Shall I inform you of something worse than that,

regarding the recompense from Allah: those who incurred the curse of Allah and His wrath, and those of whom He transformed into monkeys and swine, and those who worshipped Tdghiit; such are worse in rank, and for more astray from the straight path."} 461. When they come to you, they say: "We believe." But in fact they enter with disbelief and they go out with the same. And Allah knows all that they were hiding.} 462. And you see many of them hurrying for sin and transgression, and eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been doing . 463. Why do not the Rabbdniyyun and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing. The People of the Book are Enraged at the Believers Because oftheir Faith in Allah Allah commands: Say, O Muhammad, to those who mock and jest about your religion from among the People of the Scriptures, 4, li L>* \Ul jyl U 4Do you criticize us for no other reason than that we believe in Allah, and in what has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us)?}

215Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (59 - 63) (Part-6) Do you have any criticism or cause of blame for us, other than this? This, by no means, is cause of blame or criticism. Allah said in other Aydt, jyU& A% fc Cji iAnd they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy ofall praise!) and, i.iiSti fifij 4*1 J VL iand they could not find any cause to do so except that Allah and His Messenger had enriched them ofHis bounty.)\9:74] In an agreed upon Hadith, the Prophet sg said, «5il 1^5* jIS ji Ml J -»j»- Li *What caused Ibn Jamil to Yanqim (refuse to give Zakdh), although he was poor and Allah made him rich?»[1 Allah's statement, m%) iand that most ofyou are rebellious...) is connected to 4£ o-4% 4 tj& a: \$) ithat we believe in Allah, and in that which has been sent down to us and in that which has been sent down before (us).) Therefore, the meaning of this part of the Ayah is: we also believe that most of you are rebellious and deviated from the straight path. The PeopleoftheScripturesDeserve theWorstTorment on the Day ofResurrection Allah said next, i£\ JU: M cA- 'fr* > 3*^ 4Sfly; "Shall I inform you of something worse than that,

regarding the recompensefrom Allah?")

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1537–1567]

The Ayah commands the Prophet ﷺ to say: Shall I inform you of the worst people on the Day of Resurrection than what you think of us? They are you, with these characteristics, those who incurred the curse of Allah were expelled from His mercy, and those who incurred His wrath and anger, after which He will never be pleased with them, those of whom He transformed into monkeys and swine,) as we mentioned in Surat Al-Baqarah (2) and as we will mention in Surat Al-A'raf (7). Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that Ibn Mas'ud said, "Allah's Messenger ﷺ was asked if the current monkeys and swine were those whom Allah transformed. He said, 'No. Allah never destroyed a people by transforming them and making offspring or descendants for them. The monkeys and swine existed before that.*' This was also recorded by Muslim. 121 Allah said, 'Those who worshipped Taghut... and served them, becoming their servants. The meaning of this Ayah is: you, O People of the Scriptures, who mock our religion, which consists of Allah's Tawhid, and singling Him out in worship without others, how can you mock us while these are your characteristics? This is why Allah said, 'a Mushkil Al-Athar 4 :275 Muslim 4:2051.

227Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (59 - 63) <Part-6> is such are worse in rank...} than what you - People of the Scriptures - think of Muslims, A*- }attdfar more astray from the straight path.} 'More' in the Ayah does not mean that the other party is less' astray, but it means that the People of the Scriptures are far astray. In another Ayah, Allah said, (• • *V • • "T > -iv iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.} The Hypocrites Pretend to be Believers but Hide their Kufr Allah said, / 1 * ^ • > / 'jv -1 * 1**J .A-51 ! J»j iWhen they come to you, they say, "We believe." But in fact they enter with (an intention of) disbelief and they go out with the same.} This is the description of the hypocrites, for they pretend to be believers while their hearts hide Kufr. So Allah said; -&j} }But in fact they enter} on you, O Muhammad, iwith disbelief} in their hearts and they depart with Kufr, and this is why they do not benefit from the knowledge they hear from you, nor does the advice and reminder move them. So, }and they go out with the same} meaning, they alone, 4SJ& C %} }and Allah knows all that they were hiding.} Allah knows their secrets and what their hearts conceal, even if they pretend otherwise with His creatures, thus

pretending to be what they are not. Allah, Who has perfect knowledge of the seen and unseen, has more knowledge about the hypocrites than any of His creatures do and He will recompense them accordingly. Allah's statement, iAnd you see many of them (Jews) hurrying for sin and transgression, and eating illegal things. They hurry to devour prohibited and illegal things, still while transgressing against people, unjustly consuming their property through bribes and Riba, V? c 4Evil indeed is that which they have been doing. Indeed, horrible is that which they used to do and the transgression that they committed. Criticizing Rabbis and Learned Religious Men for Giving up on Forbidding Evil Allah said, \ % 6 kill itfs 2\$ X) » 4Why do not the Rabbaniyyin and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing.> meaning why don't the Rabbaniyyun smd the Ahbdr forbid them from this evil? The Rabbaniyyun are the scholars who are in positions of authority, while the Ahbdr are the regular scholars. iEvil indeed is that which they have been performing.} referring to the Rabbaniyyun, as 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from

Ibn ‘Abbas, 111 because they absconded forbidding evil. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “There is no Ayah in the Qur’an that has more severe admonition than this Ayah, m At-Jabari 10:450.

C 2?" :Uy ^ jU-Vfj ^WJiy do not the Rabbaniyyun and the Ahbdr forbid them from uttering sinful words and from eating illegal things. Evil indeed is that which they have been performing.}’ 1 ^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Yahya bin Ya'mar said, “ ‘Ali bin Abi Talib once gave a speech, which he started by praising Allah and thanking Him. He then said, ‘O people! Those who were before you were destroyed because they committed sins and the Rabbaniyyun and Ahbar did not forbid them from evil. When they persisted in sin, they were overcome by punishment. Therefore, enjoin righteousness and forbid evil before what they suffered also strikes you. Know that enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil does not reduce the provision or shorten the term of life.” ’ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jarir said that the Messenger of Allah gg said, ‘f'o If ilt fj iy; •wljyO ill Yj “There is no people among whom there are those who commit sins, while the rest are more powerful and mightier than the sinners, yet they do not stop them, but Allah will send a punishment upon them. Ahmad was alone with this wording.*3 * Abu Dawud recorded it, but in his narration Jarir said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah^ saying, “There is no one who resides among people committing evil among them, and they do not stop him though they are able to do so, but Allah will punish them [all] before they die.**41 111 At-Tabari 10:449. * KanzAl-Ummal 3 :683 * Ahmad 4:363. * Abu Dawud 4 :510.

^ mm mm Ibn Majah^ also recorded this Hadith. OslW-V,f*tOoi(*^ iyjpJ' e .>.1 *s ,*< (*Ti- !?j Z.X.Jl-AA gji^vg4\$©o it: ,4ii ojJuCsJ>ijJolj >b'js J iauCv^~j^»O' r»!v _V—<C>Jo-'J—al \$Ar, 1«jijji j»-fc*U-UI^=>”)tij bl,mjIjJj<pj~\ <V.-'\<<'{\^ t < *>*V & Sys ii i; j*n cj\s;> •*J? Ji ll ijij (V£J»1 j>i u gt (L5S i& (3# JjJ « <*)^ *U«yb y'JuJl & u&t^ £6 \$\$ o' V iijj ijd-i oJyV' o^LLaj 3 j3i 4 yajajf z&i \\$\$ jJ; \$\$^1 rfj o* (*^» >Jj>' ifX'-J OJJ >44j» OJ !>t£=>V J^j » >.y .i» iit <©SJts u as^ 464. The Jews say: "Allah's Hand is tied up." Be their hands tied up and be they accursed for what they uttered. Nay, both His Hands are widely outstretched . He spends as He wills. Verily, the revelation that has come to you from your Lord makes many of them increase in rebellion and disbelief. We have put enmity and hatred among them till the Day of Resurrection. Every time they kindled the fire of war, Allah extinguished it; and they (ever) strive to make mischief on the earth. And Allah does not like the mischief-makers . 465. And if only the People of the Scripture had believed and had Taqwa, We would indeed have expiated for them their sins m Ibn Mdjah 2:1329.

221Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (64 - 66) (Part-6) and admitted them to Gardens of pleasure (in Paradise).} 466. And if only they had acted according to the Tawrah, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to them from their Lord (the Qur'an), they would surely have gotten provision from above them and from underneath their feet. And among them is a Muqtasid Ummah, but for most of them; evil is their work.} The Jews Say That Allah's Hand is Tied up! Allah states that the Jews, may Allah's continuous curses descend on them until the Day of Resurrection, describe Him as a miser. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. The Jews also claim that Allah is poor, while they are rich. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah's statement, iThe Jews say, "Allah's Hand is tied up."} “They do not mean that Allah's Hand is literally tied up. Rather, they mean that He is a miser and does not spend from what He has. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him.”111 Similar was reported from Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ad-Dahhak. * Allah said in another Ayah,

'ijS& Ji iii ij} iAnd let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck, nor stretch it forth to its utmost reach (like a spendthrift), so that you become blameworthy and in severe poverty.} In this Ayah, Allah prohibits stinginess and extravagance, which includes unnecessary and improper expenditures. Allah describes stinginess by saying, / * » { til -jbi J"? iAnd let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck.} Therefore, this is the meaning that the Jews meant, may 111 At-Tabari 10:452. 121 At-Tabari 10:453.

222 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir Allah's curses be on them. Ikrimah said that this Ayah was revealed about Finhas, one of the Jews,111 may Allah curse him. We mentioned before that Finhas said, i"Truly, Allah is poor and we are rich!"} and that Abu Bakr smacked him. Allah has refuted what the Jews attribute to Him and cursed them in retaliation for their lies and fabrications about Him. Allah said, 4Be their hands tied up and be they accursed for what they uttered.} What Allah said occurred, for the Jews are indeed miserly, envious, cowards and tremendously humiliated. Allah said in other Ayat, ms43* 'f&1 Jr. t£r. JS4 iOr have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqir. Or do they envy men for what Allah has given them of His bounty? Then, We had already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and the Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom.} and, i'fol& 4Indignity is put over them.} Allah's Hands are Widely Outstretched Allah said next, 3\$ \<x si} iNay, both His Hands are widely outstretched. He spends (of His bounty) as He wills .} Allah's favors are ample, His bounty unlimited, as He owns the treasures of everything. Any good that reaches His At-Tabari 10:153.

servants is from Him alone, without partners. He has created everything that we need by night or by day, while traveling or at home and in all situations and conditions. Allah said, V j5>i c>Ij U J£=> Ji f 4And He gave you of all that you asked for, and if you count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed an extreme wrongdoer, an extreme ingrate There are many other Ayat on this subject. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal said that 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated to him that Ma'mar said that Hammam bin Munabbih said, "This is what Abu Hurayrah narrated to us that the Messenger of Allah jg said, f L* *l>w V 4lll j ~ Jli ~ c<j LI jAAj pJ k «Allah's Right Hand is perfectly full, and no amount of spending can decrease what He has, even though He spends by night and by day. Do you see how much Allah has spent since He created the heavens and earth? Yet surely it has not decreased what He has in His Right Hand. His Throne is over the water and in His Other Hand is the hold by which He raises and lowers . He also said, t <ul Jy *Allah said, 'Spend and I will spend on t/ ow.V' 1 ! This Hadith was recorded in the Two SahOisP The Revelation to the Muslims only Adds to the Transgression and Disbelief of the Jews Allah said, 111 Ahmad 2:313. Fath Al-Bari 13 :4 15 , Muslim 2 : 69 1

225 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (64 - 66) (Part-6) fire of war, Allah extinguishes it and makes their plots turn against them. Therefore, their evil plots will return to harm them. iand they (ever) strive to make mischief on earth. And Allah does not like the mischief-makers.} It is their habit to always strive to cause mischief on the earth, and Allah does not like those with such behavior. Had the People of the Book Adhered to their Book, they Would Have Acquired the Good of this Life and the Hereafter Allah said next, iAnd if only the People of the Scripture had believed and had Tacjiod...} Consequently, had the People of the Book believed in Allah and His Messenger and avoided the sins and prohibitions that

they committed; iWe would indeed have expiated for them their sins and admitted them to Gardens of pleasure (in Paradise).} meaning We would have removed the dangers from them and granted them their objectives. <(•£-> oi ijiul fj} iAnd ifonly they had acted according to the Tawrdh, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to themfrom their Lord,} meaning, the Qur'an, as Ibn 'Abbas and others said. 111 ithey would surely have gotten provision from above them and from underneath theirfeet.} Had they adhered to the Books that they have with them III At-Tabari 10:463.

i O-Xc- «il gill OlAiJl [yC. ^ t'j' 'sir-Q (*r'Qj 0; -U^ !>; iThen We gave the Book as inheritance to such ofOur servants whom We chose. Then ofthem are some who wrong themselves, and of them are some who follow a middle course, and of them are some who, by Alldt's pertnission, are Sdbiq (foremost) in good deeds. That itself is indeed a great grace. 'Adn (Eden) Paradise (everlasting Gardens) will they enter, therein will they be adorned with bracelets ofgold and pearls, and their garments there will be of silk.>[35:32-33] i% Xi* 0 j2 i oli ut 4 Z & Jji# ^ v -it ^iSf ^ <67. O Messenger! Convey what has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind. Verily, Allah guides not the people who disbelieve Commanding the Prophet to Convey the Message; PromisingHim Immunityand Protection Allah addresses His servant and Messenger Muhammad jg by the title 'Messenger' and commands him to convey all that He has sent him, a command that the Prophet jg has fulfilled in the best manner. Al-Bukhan recorded that 'A'ishah said, "Whoever says to you that Muhammad hid any part of what Allah revealed to him, then he is uttering a lie. Allah said. 40 Messenger! Convey what has been sent down to you from your Lord. Al-Bukhari collected the short form of this story here, but mentioned the full narration in another part of his book. Muslim in the Book of /man, 121 At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasal in Fath Al-Bari 8: 124. Muslim1:159.

the Book of Tafsir of their Simons also collected this Hadith. In is recorded in the Two Sahihs that 'A'ishah said, "If Muhammad hid anything from the Qur'an, he would have hidden this Ayah, />/*< \ ^ •> T*--*1 O' o -' "s'j ir'U' iti-e "-'X. 4But you did hide in yourself that which Allah will make manifest, you did fear the people while Allah had a better right that you shouldfear Him>"12 ' Al-Bukhari recorded that Az-Zuhri said, "From Allah comes the Message, for the Messenger is its deliverance and for us is submission to it." ' The Ummah of Muhammad jg has testified that he has delivered the Message and fulfilled the trust, when he asked them during the biggest gathering in his speech during the Farewell Hajj. At that time, there were over forty thousand of his Companions. Muslim recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah said in his speech on that day, pi ui O people! You shall be asked about me, so what are you going to reply? They said, "We bear witness that you have conveyed (the Message), fulfilled (the trust) and offered sincere advice." The Prophet kept raising his finger towards the sky and then pointing at them, saying, pin ji «0 Allah! Did I convey? 0 Allah! Did I convey?»,4) Allah's statement, U JJ iAnd if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message .b •*i TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :441 and An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :315 > Fath Al-B&ri 13:415, Muslim 1 : 160. 131 Fath Al-B&ri 13:512. 141 Muslim 2 :886.

meaning: If you do not convey to the people what I sent to you, then you have not conveyed My Message. Meaning, the Prophet knows the consequences of this failure. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, iAnd if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message

“It means, if you hide only one Ayah that was revealed to you from your Lord, then you have not conveyed His Message.” Allah’s statement, UO\ Si UO iAllah will protect you from mankind means, you convey My Message and I will protect, aid and support you over your enemies and will grant you victory over them. Therefore, do not have any fear or sadness, for none of them will be able to touch you with harm. Before this Ayah was revealed, the Prophet ^{sgj} was being guarded, as Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said that the Prophet[^] was vigilant one night when she was next to him; she asked him, “What is the matter, O Allah’s Messenger?” He said, «;Hji y. iaju 'iJrj tWould that a pious man from my companions guard me tonight She said, “Suddenly we heard the clatter of arms. The Prophet ^{3s} said, «?iii^ >Who is that?”. He (the new comer) replied, “I am Sa’d bin Malik (Sa’d bin Abi Waqqas).” The Prophet ^{ig} asked, SLf U> *What brought you here? He said, “I have come to guard you, Allah’s O Messenger.” m A(-Tabari 10:468.

wills,} and, Li!*> -tdc L3J»^ {Your duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} *a.*£ &S « a? i\$V&J4 j—*> ^ ^t o* uy^ ltj 1/jU t£*I* £jdt i + >*•* .> * _<> 4t /f /.T (i-* jj >-4?* >->* 5b U^» <68. Say: "O People of the Scripture! You have nothing till you act according to the Tawrdh, the Injil, and what has (now) been sent down to you from your Lord (the Qur'an)." Verily, the revelation that has come to you from your Lord makes many of them increase in rebellion and disbelief. So do not grieve for the people who disbelieve.} i69. Surely, those who believe, and those who are the Jews and the Sabians and the Christians, whosoever believed in Allah and the Last Day, and worked righteousness, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} There is no Salvation Except through Faith in the Qur'an Allah says: O Muhammad, say, 40 People of the Scripture! You have nothing...} meaning no real religion until you adhere to and implement the Tawrdh and the Injil. That is, until you believe in all the Books that you have that Allah revealed to the Prophets. These Books command following Muhammad and believing in his prophecy, all the while adhering to his Law. Before, we explained Allah’s statement, iVerily, the revelation that has come to you from your Lord makes many of them increase in rebellion and disbelief.}

232 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4So do not grieve for the people who disbelieve>, Do not be sad or taken aback by their disbelief. Allah said next, iSurely, those who believe^ referring to Muslims, 4those who are the Jews} who were entrusted with the Tawrah, 4and the Sabians.. .} a sect from the Christians and Magians who did not follow any particular religion, as Mujahid stated. As for the Christians, they are known and were entrusted with the Injil. The meaning here is that if each of these groups believed in Allah and the Hereafter, which is the Day of Judgement and Reckoning, and performed good actions, which to be so, must conform to Muhammad’s Law, after Muhammad was sent to all mankind and the Jinns. If any of these groups held these beliefs, then they shall have no fear of what will come or sadness regarding what they lost, nor will grief ever affect them. We discussed a similar Ayah before in Surat Al-Baqarah (2:62). ^ />* 4^ *•^ * * A - I y . JU154Jlj J iil jl {j* Lai} l* »jlJl *4LmL«j» 1 >- "!!? jjiy Ut£=> "5tiy bL*jlj jj; ..

470. Verily, We took the covenant of the Children of Israel and sent Messengers to them. Whenever there came to them a Messenger with what they themselves desired not, a group of them they called liars, and others among them they killed. 471. They thought there will be no Fitnah (trial or punishment), so they became blind and deaf; after that Allah turned to them (with forgiveness); yet

again many of them became blind and deaf. And Allah is the All-Seer of what they do.} Allah reminds that He took the covenant and pledges from the Children of Israel to hear and obey Him and His Messenger. They broke these pledges and covenants and followed their lusts and desires instead of the law, and whichever part of the law they agreed with, they took it. Otherwise, they abandoned it, if it did not conform to their desires. This is why Allah said, X ^ Vi 4Whenever there came to them a Messenger with what they themselves desired not - a group of them they called liars, and others among them they killed. They thought there will be no Fitnah (trial or punishment) so they became blind and deaf.} thinking that they would suffer no repercussions for of the evil that they committed. Consequently, they were blinded from the truth and became deaf, incapable of hearing the truth. For these reasons they were unable to be guided by it. Allah forgave that, then, 4^1 \f^} 4yet they became blind and deaf} again, C,^ 'if; Jg %L=} 4many of them, and Allah is the All-Seer of what they do.} He has perfect knowledge of what they do and whomever among them deserves the guidance and whomever deserves misguidance.

'<S~i gyyJ* JSj i*' 'jStt JLS UJ jLJji aIijU 4J^Jl 4iJ> f>. Juli J £r* clj . . ^ a *-< '*^ @^2* oj c£sii& 472 . Surely, they have disbelieved who say: "Allah is the Messiah [Isa], son of Maryam." But the Messiah said: "O Children of Israel! worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord" Verily, whosoever sets up partners (in worship) with Allah, then Allah has forbidden Paradise for him, and the Fire will be his abode. And for the wrongdoers there are no helpers. 473 . Surely, they have disbelieved who say: "Allah is the third of three." And there is no god but One Cod (Allah). And if they cease not from what they say, verily, a painful torment will befall on the disbelievers among them.} i74. Will they not repent to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 475 . The Messiah [Isa], son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him. His mother [Maryam] was a Siddiqah. They both used to eat food. Look how We make the Ayat clear to them; yet look how they are deluded away (from the truth).} The Disbelief of the Christians; '! sa Only called to Tawhid Allah states that the Christians such sects as Monarchite, Jacobite and Nestorite are disbelievers, those among them who say that Isa is Allah. Allah is far holier than what they attribute to Him. They made this claim in spite of the fact that "Isa made it known that he was the servant of Allah and His Messenger. The first words that Isa uttered when he was still a baby in the cradle were, "I am 'Abdullah (the servant of Allah)." He did not say, "I am Allah," or, "I am the son of

235 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (72 - 75) (Part-6 Allah." Rather, he said. «!>' JLC 4Verily , I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet . until he said, -k>e tii UJ-ili i"Attid verily Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him (Alone). That is the straight path.}" He also proclaimed to them when he was a man, after he was sent as a Prophet, commanding them to worship his Lord and their Lord, alone without partners, 4A *k !M;; j;& '&> iBut the Messiah said, "O Children of Israel! worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord." Verily, whosoever sets up partners with Allah . . .\$> in worship; H3 iliif fS % ^ i-. then Allah has forbidden Paradise for him, and the Fire will be his abode. as He will send him to the Fire and forbid Paradise for him. Allah also said; iVerily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him (in worship), but He forgives except that (anything else) to whom He wills> and, iAnd the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise; "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provide you with." They will say: "Allah has forbidden both to the disbelievers

237 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (72 - 75) (Part-6) Allah replied, 4VS % i\$ i Jt^} iBut there is no god but One God.} meaning there are not many worthy of worship but there is only One God without partners, and He is the Lord of all creation and all that exists. Allah said next, while threatening and admonishing them, // I s • f ^ \ i/ they cease not from what they say,} their lies and false claims, m Xk Ukk} iverily, a painful torment will befall the disbelievers among them.} in the Hereafter, shackled and tormented. Allah said next, S'* i' &} iWill they not repent to Allah and ask His Forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This demonstrates Allah's generosity, kindness and mercy for His creatures, even though they committed this grave sin and invented such a lie and false allegation. Despite all of this, Allah calls them to repent so that He will forgive them, for Allah forgives those who sincerely repent to Him. 'Isa is Allah's Servant and His Mother is a Truthful Believer Allah said, Vi^ VL V Vi V* c-iif& iThe Messiah, son of Maryam, was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him.} 'Isa is just like the previous Prophets, and he is one of the servants of Allah and one of His honorable Messengers. Allah said in another Ayah, V 3j ji j\} iHe ['Isa] was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor

to him, and We made him an example for the Children of Israel. Allah said next, iHis mother was a Siddiqah for she believed in Allah with complete trust in Him. This is the highest rank she was given, which proves that she was not a Prophet. Allah said next, 4They both used to eat food\$ needing nourishment and to relieve the call of nature. Therefore, they are just servants like other servants, not may Allah's continued curses cover them until the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next, ^ aasms a ^ \jJc- j4 I(J-atsJ5 \ J jLS^jWly>l 1 ^ /> / > / < . ^ j.jlio^U.'lc-, jj>i _\$y^= ' 1-3- -* ^ li J ^fjfiL»^^pA)j££zx #Ujlp-AjaJ»ilU > ilg ^uajLSU^ILi^yjli^LiU OJj^==£l^l J J^Sa-O-13 gods as ignorant Christian sects claim, 4cr0\ 4Look how We make the Ayat clear to them ^ making them unequivocal and plain, 4yet look how they are deluded away (from the truth). look at the opinions, misguided ideas, and claims they cling to, even after Our clarification and plain, unequivocal explanation. yt 'iifj L«3i Vj p^=t3 V C jjif v^Jji W fA •1>A1 Vj 0»J' JI-t j i>ljj V >y£is=Jl J_*\s j» . Y'1

&£ ijky i^=,bk# jJi o; ijLi JLi <76. Say: "How do you« worship besides Allah something which has no power either to harm or to benefit you? But it is Allah Who is the All-Hearer, All-Knower."} 477. Say: "O People of the Scripture! Exceed not the limits in your religion beyond the truth, and do not follow the vain desires of people who went astray before and who misled many, and strayed (themselves) from the right path."} The Prohibition of Shirk (Polytheism) and Exaggeration in the Religion Allah admonishes those who take up rivals with Him and worship the idols, monuments and false deities. Allah states that such false deities do not deserve any degree of Divinity. Allah said, 43*^ 4Say} O Muhammad, to those from among the Children of Adam, such as the Christians, who worship other than Allah, 4£Z%£ 4How do you worship besides Allah something which has no power either to harm or to benefit you?} meaning, which cannot prevent harm for you nor bring about your benefit, 4But it is Allah Who is the All-Hearer, All-Knower.} He hears what His servants say and has knowledge of all things. Therefore, how did you worship inanimate objects that do not hear, see or know anything - having no power to bring harm or benefit to themselves let alone others - instead of worshipping Allah? Allah then said, / » / j/ »>, , i > t / / • / ^ , •> 4Say : "O People of the Scripture! Exceed not the limits in your religion beyond the truth,}

Meaning: Do not exceed the limits concerning the truth and exaggeration in praising whom you were commanded to honor. You exaggerated in his case and elevated him from the rank of Prophet to the rank of a god. You did this with Isa, who was a Prophet, yet you claimed that he is god besides Allah. This error occurred because you followed your teachers, the advocates of misguidance who came before your time and who, 4...and who misled many, and strayed (themselves) from the right path,} deviated from the straight path, to the path of misguidance and deviation. IL eU'i S; [*y^>=» -dsf} U ^ Y VA, C. u lj- ~c- ZZ C Sil 1^=* Si' ^ ^ \$^£2 jlj A' |S» iif -L>*1 J ,\$. Sgfj iujl (Ujiilf u& i tj it 47S. 77iose among the Children of Israel who disbelieved were cursed by the tongue of Dawud and 'Isa, son of Maryam. Tltat was because they disobeyed (Allah and the Messengers) and were ever transgressing (beyond the bounds).} 479. They used not to forbid one another from the evil tthey committed. Vile indeed was what they used to do.} 480. You see many of them taking the disbelievers as their friends. Evil indeed is that which they have sentforward before themselves ; for tlmt (reason) Allah is wrath with them, and in torment they will abide.} 481. And had tthey believed in Allah, and in the Prophet and in what has been revealed to him, never would they have taken them asfriends; but many ofthem are rebellious.} Allah Cursed the Disbelievers Among the Children of Israel Allah states that He has cursed the disbelievers among the Children of Israel long ago, and revealed this fact to His

Prophets Dawud and “Isa, son of Maryam. He cursed them because they disobeyed Allah and transgressed against His creatures. Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “They were cursed in the Tawrah, the Injil, the Zabur (Psalms) and the Furqan (Qur’an).” Allah then states that during their time, their habit was that, iThey used not to forbid one another from the evil they committed.} They did not forbid each other from committing sins and the prohibitions. Allah chastised them for this behavior, so that their behavior would not be imitated. Allah said, £ ^Li} iVile indeed was what they used to do.} Hadiths that Order Enjoining Righteousness and Forbidding Evil There are many Hadiths that order enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. Imam Ahmad recorded that Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman said that the Prophet sg said, j! <3)1 ji i jSsHil j yS •ci-jlj jw i;XP Ctic. oBy He in Whose Hand is my soul! You will enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, or Allah will send a punishment on you from Him. Then, you will supplicate to Him, but He will not accept your supplication j* 11 At-Tirmidhi also recorded it and said, “This Hadith is Hasan.”*21 Muslim recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, t aJLJLj — u)* i <jLij 3)3 ^ \ iS^j * > * f ' ,! , 111 Ahmad 5:388 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:39 1

Recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and Ibn Majah . ' 11 At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib from this route of narration.” Imam Ahmad recorded that Hudhayfah said that the Prophet S& said, sj JJb jl \ N u/ f is not required of the Muslim tluit lte humiliate himself> They said, ‘How does one humiliate himself?’ he said; «jj* n uj i^3i jf aHe fuites on fria/s f/taf /ie is not capable ofenduring .“ ,2! This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah, and At- Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Hasan Sahih Gharib.”*3' Censuring the Hypocrites Allah said, 4Vow see /Many of them taking the disbelievers as theirfriends Mujahid said that this Ayah refers to the hypocrites. Allah’s statement, iEvil indeed is that which they have sent forward before themselves by giving their loyalty and support to the disbelievers, instead of the believers. This evil act caused them to have hypocrisy in their hearts and brought them the anger of Allah, that will remain with them until the Day of Return. Allah said; 4_- ill' iuu cfy ifor that (reason) Allah is wrath with them\$ because ofwhat they did. Allah next said that, 1*1 Abu Dawud

4:514, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:395, and Ibn Majah Ahmad 5 :1405. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :531 , Ibn Majah 2 :1332.

244 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir miJj iiSBMS » XiK ./ wSWfs'Ss*s" <*> i»,v/ flp CtoclxlilI^f_jj»3 liJJJii-JaJl ife&sys\$ s8j2Ec4^i^v)i«.4j 5J it i_ji5(J ©3® %] tin torment they will abided on the Day of Resurrection. Allah's statement, **\ |>*l^=» SJj^ a 4l -J^l fcj^ ^iUjI ^jjl^i Alll JUtWfjicA <% 4A«d had they believed in Allah, and in the Prophet and in what has been revealed to him, never would they have taken them as friends. meaning, had they sincerely believed in Allah, His Messenger and the Qur'an, they would not have committed the evil act of supporting the disbelievers in secret and being enemies with those who believe in Allah, the Prophet jg and what was revealed to him, W & M> 4but many of them are rebellious disobedient to Allah and His Messenger and defiant of the Ayat of His revelation that He sent down. i-k-jjJj Lfy& v^J'j ijQi <y\$, iySS oflti iii ojL>2j •\$5-^ > t ; ot IjLil* ij^j 5a> G* gfiJl'" d>i 4^ 10 J>' t- ii|S V ^hh'j UiL l*_» <LL V l3 l>j U Hil; b!_, ojLij <^>Ji '(y, !\$fi £i &&%U^ £ |2; GLjI <J £12; ^fS < i*i£=; ojifj Sj£- ^iVi' t^2 sfj. jl (tSchbl

killJl T:Vill 482 . Verily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say : "We are Christians." That is because among them are priests and monks, and they are not proud.} 483. And when they listen to what has been sent down to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears because of the truth they have recognized. They say: "Our Lord! We believe; so write us down among the witnesses."} 484. "And why should we not believe in Allah and in that which has come to us of the truth? And we wish that our Lord will admit us along with the righteous people."} 485. So because of what they said, Allah awarded them with Gardens under which rivers flow, they will abide therein forever. Such is the reward of good-doers .} 486. But those who disbelieved and belied Our Ayat, they shall be the dwellers of Hell.}

The Reason Behind Revealing these Ayat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1567–1597]

Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi and others said that these Ayat were revealed concerning a delegation that An-Najashi (King of Ethiopia) sent to the Prophet jg in order to hear his words and observe his qualities. When the delegation met with the Prophet and he recited the Qur'an to them, they embraced Islam, cried and were humbled. Then they returned to An-Najashi and told him what happened. 11 ' 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah commented, "They were Ethiopians who embraced Islam when the Muslims who migrated to Ethiopia resided among them." Qatadah said, "They were some followers of the religion of Isa, son of Maryam, who when they saw Muslims and heard the Qur'an, they became Muslims without hesitation."12 ' Ibn Jarir said that these Ayat were revealed concerning some people who fit this description, whether they were from Ethiopia or otherwise. Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 10:499,500. 121 At-Tabari 10:501.

iVerily, you will find the strongest among men in enmity to the believers the Jews and those who commit Shirk,} This describes the Jews, since their disbelief is that of rebellion, defiance, opposing the truth, belittling other, people and degrading the scholars. This is why the Jews - may Allah's continued

curses descend on them until the Day of Resurrection - killed many of their Prophets and tried to kill the Messenger of Allah ^ several times, as well as, performing magic spells against him and poisoning him. They also incited their likes among the polytheists against the Prophet Allah's statement, and you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say: "We are Christians."} refers to those who call themselves Christians, who follow the religion of the Messiah and the teachings of his Injil. These people are generally more tolerant of Islam and its people, because of the mercy and kindness that their hearts acquired through part of the Messiah's religion. In another Ayah, Allah said; Vj O'j iAnd We ordained in the hearts of those who followed him, compassion, mercy, and monasticism . .> [57:27]. In their book is the saying; "He who strikes you on the right cheek, then turn the left cheek for him." And fighting was prohibited in their creed, and this is why Allah said, Ij intended by it should be clear to the reader. However, the remainder of the Ayah, which can be translated as ; 4that they invented which We did not prescribe for them.} (referring to monasticism) obviously contradicts Ibn Kathir's objective here. He himself discusses this issue shortly, as well as at the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hadid., as will appear later, if Allah wills.

iThat is because among them are Qissin (priests) and Ruhban (monks), and they are not proud. This means that among them are Qissin (priests). The word Ruhban refers to one dedicated to worship. Allah said, iThat is because among them are priests and monks, and they are not proud. This describes them with knowledge, worship and humbleness, along with following the truth and fairness. 44^' Oi gfJlf JI ^ 'j 4And when they listen to what has been sent down to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears because of the truth they have recognized> This refers to the good news that they have about the advent of Muhammad jfe, ics^Lii ^ \lj iThey say: "Our Lord! We believe; so write us down among the witnesses/y who testify to the truth and believe in it. ^ £ £ CL1 J -p tit; Cj it !£ y u 6> i" And why should we not believe in Allah and in that which has come to us of the truth? And We wish that our Lord will admit us (in Paradise) along with the righteous people '> Such sect of Christians are those mentioned in Allah's statement, iAnd there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in the Truth which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah.\$>[3:199] and, 1*1 UX tjlte 'pfL !*» 'A* j?

4Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say, "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we were Mursalin">[28:52-53], until, 4"We seek not the ignorant.">[28:55] This is why Allah said here, Uj iuif)+ \$) 4So because of what they said, Allah awarded them...) rewarding them for embracing the faith and recognizing and believing in the truth, "Jri > ^ ot 4Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise), they will abide therein forever.) and they will never be removed from it, for they will dwell and remain in it forever and ever, 4Such is the reward of good-doers) who follow the truth and obey it wherever, whenever and with whomever they find it. Allah then describes the condition of the miserable. UMft 4But those who disbelieved and belied Our Ayat,) defied and opposed them, 4^»& 4they shall be the dwellers of the (Hell) Fire.) For they are the people of the Fire who will enter and reside in it (eternally). if-. V 'ifS>1 f#Js %P if ja C v \EX <*kft *& alf 'if f£3tjtf •&- ifpZ <4 in 487. O you who believe! Make not unlawful the good things

249 Surah 5 . Al-Ma'idah (87 - 88) (Part-7) which Allah has made lawful to you, and transgress not. Verily, Allah does not like the transgressors.} <\$88. And eat of the things which Allah has provided for you, lawful and good, and have Taqwa of Allah in Whom you believe.} There is No Monasticism in Islam 'AH bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This Ayah [5:87] was revealed about some of the Companions of the Prophet sg who said, "We should cut off our male organs, abandon the desires of this life and travel in the land, just as the Ruhban (monks) do.' When the Prophet heard of this statement, he summoned them and asked them if they made this statement and they answered 'Yes.' The Prophet sg said, V p& * - »' 5 1 ' 'A • </ fast and break my fast, pray and sleep, and marry women. Wlwever follmvs my Sunnah is of me, and whoever abandons my Sunnah is not of Ibn Abi Hatim also coUected this Hadith. Ibn Marduwyah recorded that Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas narrated a similar Hadith. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that 'A'ishah said that some of the Companions asked the wives of the Prophet jg about the acts of worship that he performed in private. One of them said, "I will not eat meat," another said, "I will not marry many women," while the third said, "I will not sleep on the bed." When the Prophet sg heard this statement, he said, i Jjij Jli Vi® Lr& » IA 4-f'J dr*3 **'-1)1 ' 'What is the matter with some people who said such and such? I fast and break the fast, sleep and wake to stand to pray, eat meat, and marry women. He who is not pleased with my Sunnah is not of me. At-Tabari 10:518. Similar mention of the cause of revelation is recorded by Al-Bukhari Fath Al-Bari 9:5, Muslim 2 :1020

251 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (89) (Part-7) iand have Taqwa of Allah in Whom you believe. ,233 o^vt^ c 4=4* jCij -j 4ft # £4£ 4 £>•* >A> 4,4 4 f uji-jis C -k~4 <jj j5^—* iyi j&S iit •£ 4sT jfcg ii£: 4 4-i# ££^ 4i&i ^89. /W/o/i un// not punish you for what is unintentional in your oaths, but He will punish you for your deliberate oaths; for its expiation feed ten poor, on a scale of the Awsat of that with which you feed your own families; or clothe them; or free a slave. But whosoever cannot afford, then he should fast for three days. That is tlte expiation for the oaths when you have sworn. And protect your oaths. Thus Allah makes clear to you His Ayat that you may be grateful Unintentional Oaths We mentioned the subject of unintentional oaths in Surat Al- Baqarah, all praise and thanks are due to Allah, and so we do not need to repeat it here. We also mentioned that the Laghw in oaths refers to one's saying, "No by Allah," or, "Yes, by Allah," unintentionally. Expiation for Breaking the Oaths Allah said, ibut He will punish you for your deliberate oaths.} in reference to the oaths that you intend in your hearts, f££l ifor its expiation (a deliberate oath) feed ten poor,}, who are needy, not able to find necessities of the life. Allah's statement, Si} ion a scale of the Awsat of that with which you feed your own families;} means, "On the average scale of what you feed your families. - '

according to Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and Ikrimah . 111 'Ata' Al-Khurasani commented on the Ayah, "From the best of what you feed your families".121 Allah's statement, a} ior clothe them,} refers to clothing each of the ten persons with what is suitable to pray in, whether the poor person was male or female. Allah knows best. Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah means a robe or garment for each poor person (of the ten).13' Mujahid also said that the least of clothing, referred to in the Ayah, is a garment, and the most is whatever you wish . Al-Hasan, Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, 'Ata', Tawus, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Hammad bin Abi Sulayman and Abu Malik said that it means (giving each of the ten poor persons) a garment each.15* Allah's statement, ior free a slave} refers to freeing a believing slave. In the Muwatta' of Malik, the Musnad of Ash-Shafil and the Sahih of Muslim, a lengthy Hadith was

recorded that Umar bin Al- Hakam As-Sulami said that he once had to free a slave (as atonement) and he brought a black slave girl before the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, who asked her; d' sWhere is Allah?* She said, "Above the heavens." He said, *Who am I?* She said, "The Messenger of Allah." He said, *Free her, for she is a believer .»|61 There are three types of expiation for breaking deliberate At-Tabari 10:541. At-Tabari 10:531. At-Tabari 10:547. At-Tabari 10:545. |s| At-Tabari 10:545,546. Al-Muwatfa'2 :776 , Ar-Risdlah no.75, Muslim 1 :38.

J 'TV mm V oaths, and whichever (A>^b 'j-rr**1 ^jl'rJi suffice, according to the consensus (of the ^ , scholars). Allah b J j 'oj'-ul (^ca; y.O' ' mentioned the easiest, "r:s; p". ><lil is easier than giving • > s'>'.* / •* >' away clothes, and ^ jcJljp'blj-y giving away clothes is i£jkj\jSW->\jii\UliVlS^Qc.^ easier than freein8 a , i . slave. If one is unable i~~^3 ^'(< ' to fulfill any of these options, then he fasts 7 l , for three days for expiation, just as >t e jjzxiAf ,t Allah said, juillljb'i'il jyv'-te-43iiU'i ^tf" »?./-".**<? K',- ^ " , ,»»,«<,* •>'>"<'!'.> iBut whosoever cannot iui.^iefeU^^ht.SfSi. ^ (lhalK the,, he should fast far three jit. / , < nt >-fit'* - "• '\ days . | ubayy bin ^ Ibn Mas“ud and his students read this Ayah as follows, “Then he should fast three consecutive days.” 1 11 Even if this statement was not narrated to us as a part of the Qur’an through Mutawatir narration, it would still be an explanation of the Qur’an by the Companions that has the ruling of being related from the Prophet Allah’s statement, VJZ iThat is the expiation far the oaths when you have sworn.>[5:89] means, this is the legal way to atone for deliberate oaths, At-Tabari 5 :31

iAnd protect your oaths ^ Do not leave your broken oaths without paying the expiation for them, according to the meaning given by Ibn Jarir. iThus Allah makes clear to you His Aydt} and explains them to you, 4that you may be grateful. fix pfts iuVe jar Gi \p: sir j* (5-Luj j iyIUt ^521^ J SllliJi i_»J» l2) lyixU ^Jy jji ijjiitj Jy-J' <ai }jL2)f jfcj jll Li ft*- |>_cj iyjii S-rJ' Lit 44 JS5 \$ j !££j <\$? c^iJi ijU; usr c 4 490. O you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansdb, and Azlam are a Rijs of Shaytan’s handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful.} 492 . Shaytan wants only to excite enmity and hatred between you with Khamr and Maysir, and hinder you from the remembrance ofAllah andfrom the Salah (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} 492. And obey Allah and obey the Messenger, and beivare. Then if you turn away, you should know that it is Our Messenger's duty to convey in the clearest way.} 493. Those who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate, if they have Taqwd and believe and do righteous good deeds, and they (again) have Taqwa and believe, and then (once again) have Taqwa and perform good. And Allah loves the good-doers.} ProhibitingKhamr (Intoxicants) and Maysir(Gambling) Allah forbids His believing servants from consuming Khamr and Maysir which is gambling. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that m At-Tabari 10:560,562.

a ^ Talib, the Leader of the Faithful, said that chess is of fabling.' ' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Ata’Mujahid and Jawus, or , two of them, said that every type ofgambling, including children’s playing with (a certain tyZ of)nuts is Maysir. Ibn Umar said that Al-Maysir meansgambling and this is the same statement that Ad-Dahhakreported from Ibn ‘Abbas, I4 < who added, “They used to gamble Th ° { dhUiyyah > until Islam came. Allah thenforbade them from this evil behavior.” Meaning ofAnsab and Azldm M-Ansf were altar stones, in whose vicinity sacrifices wereoffered (dunng the time of Jahiliyyah), according to Ibn ‘Abbas thafvwi »*** ’ SSld bm Jubayr and ^Hasan. They also saidUiat Af-Azla/n were arrows that they used for lotteries to makedecisions, as Ibn Abi Hatim narrated. Allah

said, 4A Rijs of Shaytan's handiwork} meaning, abomination of Shaytan's handiwork, according to Ahbm Abi Talhah who reported it from Ibn 'Abbas.,S) SaTdbin Jubayr said that Rijs means 'sin'|6) while Zayd bin Aslam said; "An evil handiwork of Shaytan."*7 ^So avoid that} avoid all of these abominations, {in order that you may be successful.} and this is a statement of encouragement. Allah said next, Ml such saying, through all of its routes, is not authentically attributable to him , may Allah be pleased with him <2 ' At-Tabari 4:322 ,323. 131 At-Tabari 4:325. 141 At-Tabari 4:324. Is ! At-Tabari 10:565. *61 At-Tabari 4:330. I7 * At-Tabari 10:565.

ji' Ji o j~fA) j 'tyxji j4y_ J jiiLili i!5 }» / .*>'1 >\ *'<.* " T " J+> o*j iShaytdn wants only to excite enmity ami hatred between you with Khamr (intoxicants) and Maysir (gambling), and hinder you from the remembrance of Allah and from the Saldli (the prayer). So, will you not then abstain?} This is a threat and a warning. Hadiths that Prohibit Khamr (Intoxicants) Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "There were three stages to prohibiting Khamr (intoxicants). When the Messenger of Allah is migrated to Al-Madlnah, the people were consuming alcohol and gambling, so they asked the Messenger of Allah \$fc; about these things, Allah revealed, iTIey ask you about alcoholic drink and gambling. Say: "In them is a great sin, and (some) benefit for men.">[2 :219], until the end of the Ayah. The people said, They (intoxicants and gambling) were not prohibited for us. Allah only said. {In them is a great sin, and (some) benefit for inen.y So they went on drinking Khamr until one day, one of theemigrants lead his companions in the Maghrib prayer andmixed up the Ayat in his recitation. Thereafter Allah 1down a tougher statement, ' 1 senl 'i-% i&* IE2 i ip:ajf what you utter.)(4 :43j : "0W ttteamttg of) so^thatt/Sd"IS l>Cf0r° 'hC Ume °f "» Player Ayah was later revealed P™5™ Whi° sober-A ^mer ^^ ** «-»x*XX& <h <U 5

257Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (90 - 93) (Part-7) 40 you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansdb, and Azldm are an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid that in order that you may be successful>[5:90-91] So they said, *We abstained, O Lord!' Later, some people said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Some people died in the cause of Allah, while some others died in their beds, but they used to drink alcohol and indulge in gambling, which Allah has made a Rijs of the work of Shaytan.' So Allah sent down, ./ . l>vi + * •> s/ iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate...> [5:93], until the end of the Ayah. The Prophet sg said, U5 IjS? tfX* > "Had they been made impermissible for them, they would have abandoned them as uou have abandoned them .» Ahmad recorded this HadithJ Imam Ahmad recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "O Allah! Explain the verdict about Khamr to us clearly." The Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed, pi tfi j* JUJj iTIey ask you about alcoholic drink and gambling. Say: "In them is a great sin.">[2:219] Umar was summoned and this Ayah was recited to him, but he still said, "O Allah! Make the verdict of Khamr clear to us." Then the Ayah in Surat An-Nisa.'was revealed, 40 you who believe! Do not approach the Salah when you are in a drunken state.^[4:43] Thereafter, the Prophet had someone herald when it was time to pray, "Those in a drunken state are not to approach the prayer." Umar was again summoned and the Ayah was recited to him, but he still said, "O Allah! Make the verdict concerning HI Ahmad 2 :351

Khamr clear to us." Then, the Ayah in Surat Al-M&'idah [5:91] was revealed, and TJmar was summoned and it was recited to him. When he reached the part ofthe Ayah that reads, iSo, will you not then abstain?^[5:91], Umar said, "We abstained, we abstained."111 Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and An-

Nasal¹²¹ recorded this Hadith. ‘Ali bin Al- Madini and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahih. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, that Umar bin Al-Khattab said in a speech; while standing on the Minbar of the Messenger of Allah (in the Prophet’s Masjid in Al-Madlnah) “O people! The prohibition of Khamr was revealed; and Khamr was extracted from five things: From grapes, dates, honey, wheat and barley. Khamr is what intoxicates the mind.”¹³¹ Al- Bukhari recorded that Ibn Umar said, “The prohibition of Khamr was revealed when there were five kinds of intoxicants in Al-Madlnah, besides what was produced from grapes.” Another Hadith• Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said, “I once was giving an alcoholic beverage to Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah, Ubayy bin KaTj, Suhayl bin Bayda’ and several of their friends meeting at Abu Talhah’s house. When they were almost intoxicated, some Muslims came and said, ‘Did you not know that Khamr has been prohibited?’ They said, ‘We’ll wait and ask.’ They then said, ‘O Anas! Spill the remaining alcohol out of your container.’ By AMh! They never drank it again, and their Khamr at that time was made from unripe and normal dates. ,|s| This is also recorded in the Two Sahihs. In another narration by Anas, “I was the butler of the people in the house of Abu Talhah when Khamr was prohibited, and in those days alcohol was made from unripe and normal dates. A caller then Ahmad 1 :53. Abu DSwud 4 :79 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:417, An-Nasal 8 :286 Fath Al-Bari 8 :126 , Muslim 4 :2322 141 Fath Al-Bari 8 :126 Ahmad 3:181.

heralded, and Abu Talhah ordered me to see what it was about. So I found that a person was announcing that alcoholic drinks had been prohibited. Abu Talhah ordered me to go out and spill the wine. I went out and spilled it, and it flowed in the streets of Al-Madlnah. Some people said, ‘Some people were killed and wine was still in their stomachs.’ Later on, Allah’s revelation came, iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate..>[5:93].’^{^11} Ibn Jarir recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “I was serving Abu Talhah, Abu ‘Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah, Abu Dujanah, Mu’adh bin Jabal and Suhayl bin Bayda’, until they became intoxicated from an alcoholic drink made of mixed unripe and normal dates. Then I heard someone herald, ‘Khamr has been made illegal.’ So no one went in or out until we spilled the alcohol and broke its barrels. Some of us then performed ablution and others took a shower, and we wore some perfume. We then went out to the Masjid while the Messenger of Allah jg was reciting, & k Sf? js; at \-p: si; 40 you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansab, and Azldm are only an abomination of Shaytan's handiwork. So avoid that...>[5:90], until, it iSo, zoill you not then abstain?^5:91]. A man asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! What about those who died drinking it?’ Allah sent down the verse. i\yUq iff ijLi; \jx ^i;& iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate.}[5:93]. {2 ' FathAl-Bari 5:133, Muslim 3:1570. At-Tabari 10:578.

Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jjg said, . 1_ . * i ; . <>j I e old JS\j 4a3] tUj-plpJ l «ifea aTen matters related to Khamr were cursed. Khamr itself was cursed, whoever drinks it, its server, seller, buyer, brewer, who asks for it to be brewed, whoever carries it, whomever it is carried to and whoever consumes its priced Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah’2 * recorded this Hadith. Ahmad recorded that Ibn “Umar said, “Once, the Messenger of Allah jg went out and I went out with him. I walked to his right, but Abu Bakr came along and I gave way to him, and Abu Bakr was walking on the Prophet’s right, while I was walking on his left. Then ‘Umar came along and he was walking on the Prophet’s left, since I gave way to him. The Messenger of Allah then found a leather skin hanging containing alcohol, so he asked for a knife and ordered that the skin be cut open. He then said, t«iii j itjbU-j OIJ 11 iKhamr was cursed, and so are those who drink it, serve it, sell it, buy

it, carry it, have it carried to them, brew it, have it brewed and consume its price .n”*31 Another Hadith Al-H&fiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Sa’d said, “There were four Ayat revealed about Khamr...” He then said, “A man from AJ-Ansar made some food and invited us. We drank Khamr before it was prohibited and became intoxicated, and thus started to boast about our status. The Ansar said that 111 Ahmad 2:25. l2l Abu Dawud no.2674, Ibn Majah no.3380. ,3> Ahmad 2 :71

they were better, while Quraysh (the Muhajirin) said that they were better. So a man from the Ansar took a bone and struck Sa'd's nose with it and made a flesh wound on it. Ever since that happened, Sa'd's nose had a scar from that wound. The Ayah, ilntoxicants gambling,} until, 4So, will you not then abstain?} was later revealed.” Muslim recorded this Hadith} Another Hadith Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said, “This Ayah in the Qur’an, vH- Ji (jjib vU>Vi> j-pij _pii 40 you who believe! Khamr, Maysir, Ansdb, and Azlam are only an abomination of Shaytdn's handiwork. So avoid that m order that you may be successful.}[5:90\, was also in the Tawrah; ‘Allah has sent down truth to eradicate falsehood, joyful play, flute or wind instruments, Zafan (dances) and Kib&rat (refering to cabarets using the lute and bagpipe), tambourine, guitar, harp and lyric and love poetiy. And Khamr is bitter for those who taste it. Allah has vowed by His grace and power, Whoever drinks it after I prohibited it, I will make him thirsty on the Day of Resurrection. Whoever abandons it after I prohibited it, I will let him taste it in the residence of Grace (Paradise).” Its chain of narration is Sahth121 Another Hadith Ash-Shafit narrated that Malik narrated that Nafi‘ said that Ibn ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *** Al-Bayhaqi 8:285, Muslim no.1748. ,2] Ibn AbiHadm 4 : 1 196

a? 4v*- 44 4-4 4* P 4^^ j uWhoever drinks Khamr in the life of this world and does not repentfrom it, will be deprived of it in the Hereafter . Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this HadithJ * Muslim recorded that Ibn ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, pj 44-4 4jUi 14j * <3*“ •j>Vtj 41>L:p it<4 4J: «Every intoxicant is Khamr, and every intoxicant is unlawful. Whoever drinks Khamr and dies while addicted to it, without repentingfrom drinking it, will notdrink it in the Hereafter. »[2] ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Harith bin Hisham said that he heard Uthman bin ‘Affan saying, “Avoid Khamr, for it is the mother of all sins. There was a man before your time who used to worship Allah secluded from the people. Later, an evil woman loved him and sent her female servant to him saying that they wanted him to witness something. So he went with the servant. Whenever they went through the door, she locked it behind them, until he reached a beautiful woman with a young servant boy and some alcohol. She said to him, By Allah! I did not invite you to be a witness for anything, but called you to have sex with me, kill this boy or drink this alcohol.’ So she gave him some alcohol, and he kept asking for more until he [became intoxicated and) had sex with her and killed the boy. Therefore, avoid Khamr, because it is never combined with faith, but one of them is bound to expei the other (from the heart).” This was recorded by Al-Bayhaqi.13’ This statement has an authentic chain of narration. Abu Bakr bin Abi Ad-Dunya recorded this statement in his book on the prohibition of intoxicants, but he related it from the Prophet. 5^5 Relating it from ‘Uthman is more authentic, and Allah knows best. Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “When ' Musnad Ash-Shaft'lno . 1763 , Al-Bukhari no .5575 , Muslim 2003 . I2 ' Muslim no .2003 . 131 Al-Bayhaqi 8 :287 ,288 .

Khamr was prohibited, some people said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! What about our brethren who died while still drinking Khamr?’ Allah sent down the Ayah Ej -V'dlUI'l ijLij dl/jj' iThose who believe and do

righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate,} until the end of the Ayah. When the Qiblah (direction of the prayer) was changed (from Jerusalem to Makkah), some people asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! What about our brethren who died while still praying toward Jerusalem?’ Allah sent down, {4} And Allah would never make your faith to be lost.>”(2: 143)m ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud said that the Prophet said when the Ayah, c \i[ryiq \pc &£} iThose who believe and do righteous good deeds, there is no sin on them for what they ate, if they have Taqwd, and believe...} was revealed, "p oil JJ8 «/ was told, that you are among them .b This is the narration that Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal¹²¹ collected. M S 'if pcs, pJ fa SS\$ St -iH if)\$X f £fe> \‘S pi&& * iip: iif ifk mz ssz£^ & Csp sc& .4,p j4 *53 P& S'> j*, <jL£ £f- iii jCj ojjJ viU'j Jj* f ;JaT y> x?^^ m Ahmad 1:295. f2 ' Muslim 4:1910, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:419, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra

494. O you who believe! Allah will certainly make a trial for you with something in the game that is well within reach of your hands and your lances, that Allah may test who fears Him in the unseen. Then whoever transgresses thereafter, for him there is a painful torment.} 495. O you who believe! Kill not game while you are in a state of Ihram, and whosoever of you kills it intentionally, the penalty is an offering, brought to the Ka'bah, of livestock equivalent to the one he killed, as adjudged by two just men among you; or, for expiation, he should feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting, that he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed. Allah has forgiven what is past, but whosoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him. And Allah is Almighty, All-Able of Retribution.} Prohibiting Hunting Game in the Sacred Area and During the State of Ihram [*Ali bin Abi Talhah] Al-Walibi said that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Allah’s statement, 'fiJ 4Alldh will certainly make a trial for you with something in (the matter of) the game that is well within reach of your hands and your lances,}[5:94], refers to, “The weak and young game. Allah tests His servants with such game during their Ihram, that if they wish, they would be able to catch it with their hands. Allah has commanded them to avoid catching it.” * Mujahid said that, iwell within reach of your hands} refers to the young game and chicks, while ipCf} 4and your lances,} refers to mature game.*2 * Muqatil bin Hayyan said that this Ayah was revealed during the ‘Umrah of 111 At-Tabari 10:584. * At-Tabari 10:583.

Al-Hudaybiyyah, when wild game and birds were coming to the Muslim camping area, which they had never seen the likes of before. Allah prohibited them from hunting the game while in the state of Ihram, ithat Allah may test who fears Him in the unseen . \$»• 1 Therefore, Allah tests His servants with the game that comes near their camping area, for if they wish, they can catch it with their hands and spears in public and secret. This is how the obedience of those who obey Allah in public and secret becomes apparent and tested. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4 ,-'U sA> bj" ori!" iVerily! Those who fear their Lord in the unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward (i.e. Paradise).} Allah said next, M tSXil yj} whoever transgresses thereafter.} after this warning and threat, according to As-Suddi, then, /&} ifbr him there is a painful torment.} for his defiance of Allah’s command and what He has decreed. Allah said next, 40 you who believe! Kill not game while you are in a state of Hiram,} This Ayah prohibits killing the game in the state of Ihram, except what is exempt from this as mentioned in the Two Sahihs; ‘A’ishah narrated that the Messenger of Allah said, Jt m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur³ :185

"Five are Fawdsiq, they may be killed while in Ihrdm or not the crow, the kite, the scorpion, the mouse and the rabid dogM Ibn ‘Umar narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, •jjiJl lOjldJlj II jAxi\j «Jf is

not harmful in a state of Ihram to kill five kinds of animals: the crow, the kite, the scorpion, the mouse and the rabid dog. ¹²¹ This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahihs. (31 Ayyub narrated that Nafi' narrated similar wordings for this Hadith from Ibn Tjmar. *4 * Ayyub said, "So I said to Nafi', What about the snake?' He said, There is no doubt that killing the snake is allowed. '",⁵, The ruling concerning the rabid dog also includes the wolf, lion, leopard, tiger and their like, since they are more dangerous than the rabid dog, or because the term Kalb (dog) covers them. Allah knows best. Abu Said narrated that the Prophet jg was asked about the animals that the Muhrim is allowed to kill and he said. «& ij oi>ii oThe snake, the scorpion, the mouse, and the crow - which is shot at but not killed - the rabid dog, the kite and wild beasts of prey.' Abu Dawud recorded this Hadith, as did At-Tirmidhi, who said, "Hasan", and Ibn MajahJ61 Al-Bukhari no. 3314, Muslim no. 1198. Al-Muwatta' 1 :356. [31 Fath Al-Bari 4 :42 , Muslim 2 :858 141 An-Nasal 5:190. Fath Al-Bari 6 :44 161 Abu Dawud 2 :424 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 3 :576, Ibn Majah 2 :1032

The PenaltyofKillingGame in the SacredArea or in the State ofIhram Allah said, J1* l* •'>>> j*JT \$Atid whosoever ofyou kills it intentionally, the penalty is [an offering of] livestock equivalent to the one he killed. Mujahid bin Jabr said, "The meaning of 'intentionally' here is that one intends to kill the game while forgetting that he is in the state of Ihram. Whoever intentionally kills the game while aware that he is in the state of Ihram, then this offense is more grave than to make an expiation, and he also loses his Ihram This statement is odd, and the view of majority is that they have to pay the expiation for killing the game whether they forgot that they are in Ihram or not. Az-Zuhri said, "The Book (the Qur'an) asserts the expiation for intentional killing, and the Sunnah included those who forget, as well."¹²¹ The meaning of this statement is that the Qur'an mentioned the expiation and sin of those who intentionally kill game, '-.t- Cf- 4iil tti y ithat he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed. Allah has forgiven what is past, but whosoever commits it again, Allah will take retributionfrom him.} the Sunnah that includes the rulings issued by the Prophet jg and his Companions, indicated the necessity of expiation in cases of unintentional killing of game, just as the Book legislated expiation for intentional killing. Killing game is a form of waste, which requires expiation in intentional and unintentional cases, although those who intend it have sinned, rather than those who made an honest error. Allah's statement, iJii j4 :i>o> iThe penalty is [an offering of] livestock equivalent to the one he killed.} ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 11 :8. At-Tabari 11:11.

indicates the necessity of offering an equivalent animal to the one the Muhrim killed. The Companions gave rulings that the camel, for instance, is the equivalent of the ostrich, the cow is the equivalent of wild cattle, and the goat for the deer. As for the cases when there is no equivalent for the killed animal, Ibn 'Abbas said that one should spend its amount in Makkah (i.e. charity), as Al-Bayhaqi recorded. Allah's statement, iAs adjudged by two just men among you;} means, two just Muslim men should determine an animal equivalent to the game killed, or the amount of its price. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Jarir Al-Bajali said, "1 killed a deer when I was in the state of Ihram and mentioned this fact to Tjmar, who said, 'Bring two of your brethren and let them judge you.' So I went to 'Abdur-Rahman and Sa'd and they said that I should offer a male sheep." Ibn Jarir recorded that Tariq said, "Arbad killed a deer while in the state of Ihram and he went to 'Umar to judge him. *Umar said to him, 'Let us both judge,' and they judged that Arbad should offer a goat that was fed on abundant water and grass. 'Umar commented, 4'fai Iji fiSe} 4As adjudged by two just men among you ;^." ¹²¹ Allah's statement,

£ (£> 4...an offering brought to the Ka'bah .} indicates that this equivalent animal should be brought to the Ka'bah, meaning, the Sacred Area, where it should be slaughtered and its meat divided between the poor of the Sacred Area. There is a consensus on this ruling. Allah said, 4fiC«z liU'j Jo* }' ji 4or, for expiation, he should feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting,} 111 At-Tabari 11 :27. At-Tabari 11 :26.

269Siiralt 5. Al-Md'ida}i (94 - 95) (Part-7) that is, if the Muhrim does not find an equivalent to what he killed, or the animal hunted is not comparable to anything else. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, «L'C, 4-S& i id, VJZ i Cz) 4...an offering brought to the Ka'bah, or, for expiation, he should feed the poor, or its equivalent in fasting .> “If the Muhrim killed game, then his judgement is its equivalent. If he kills an antelope, he offers a sheep slaughtered in Makkah. If he cannot, then he feeds six poor people, otherwise he should fast for three days. If he kills a deer, he offers a cow. If unable, he feeds twenty poor people, or otherwise if unable, he fasts for twenty days. If he kills an ostrich or zebra, he offers a camel, or he feeds thirty poor people, or fasts thirty days.” Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this statement, and in Ibn Jarir’s narration, the food measurement is a Mudd (4 handfuls of food) each that suffices for the poorJ 11 Allah’s statement, 4that he may taste the heaviness (punishment) of his deed.) means, We have required him to pay this expiation so that he tastes the punishment of his error, 4<1& tie) 4Allah has forgiven what is past.) during the time of Jdhiliyyah, provided that one becomes good in Islam and follows Allah’s Law, all the while avoiding the sin. Allah then said, 4*h £j) 4but whosoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him.) meaning, whoever does this after it has been prohibited in Islam and having knowledge that it is prohibited, m At-Tabari 1 1 :31

iAlldh will take retribution from him. And Allah is Almighty, All-Able of retribution .} Ibn Jurayj said, “I said to ‘Ata’, What is the meaning of, ii- Jjl &c} 4Allah has forgiven what is past.}?” He said, ‘Meaning, during the time of Jdhiliyyah.’ I asked about, 4! j Iff} 4but whosoever commits it again, Allah will take retribution from him.} He said, Whoever commits this offense again in Islam, then Allah will take retribution from him and he also has to pay the expiation.’ I asked, ‘Is there any punishment for repeating this offense that you know of?’ He said, ‘No.’ I said, ‘Do you think that the authorities should punish him?’ He said, ‘No, for it is a sin that he committed between him and Allah. He should pay the expiation.’” 111 Ibn Jarir recorded this statement. It was said that the ‘Allah will take retribution’ refers to the expiation, according to Sa‘Id bin Jubayr, ‘Ata’, and the majority among the earlier and later generations. 121 They stated that when the Muhrim kills game, the expiation becomes necessary, regardless of whether it was the first, second or third offense, and whether intentional or by error. Ibn Jarir commented on Allah’s statement; 4 S* *\$>} 4And Allah is Almighty, All-Able of retribution.} “Allah says that He is invincible in His control, none can resist Him, prevent Him from exacting retribution from anyone, or stop Him from punishing anyone. This is because all creation is His creation and the decision is His, His is the might, and His is the control. His statement, 4j&f 111 At-Tabari 11 :48. •2| At-Tabari 11 :50.

^All-Able of retribution .)> meaning, He punishes those who disobey Him for their disobedience of Him.” J3 Sg.p ££ p >-*0 l* JU*> w/J' jS SZi\ a JSf. # f&K o-ilu c& •,1 1^1 4* i^ifj ias j Uj Oy4J' j U jjLL iii tur ^ c£?W' 4£& d3 t?Ui fjL4 J£i S % pj\ pi% gif & £ 4l|\$S^3 Cj££ £ 496. Lawful to you is water game and its use for food -for the benefit of yourselves and those who travel, but forbidden is (the

pursuit of) land game as long as you are in a state of Ihram. And have Taqwa of Allah to Whom you shall be gathered back.\$ 497. Allah has made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of security and benefits for mankind, and also the Sacred Month and the animals of offerings and the garlanded, that you may know that Allah has knowledge of all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and that Allah is the All-Knower of each and everything jh v.kbshss m ©nsa IgS&sl JSoi ofji <i , ffK1. i >4i<\+ x4 £ <V\ »y't\s"< **i..Uljy i j Ji O ij&H i p£ <pd>_ \$ At-Tabari 11 :57.

As-Suddi and others. Imam Malik bin Anas recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “Allah’s Messenger jg sent an army towards the east coast and appointed Abu ‘Ubaydah bin Al- Jarrah as their commander, and the army consisted of three hundred men, including myself. We marched on until we reached a place where our food was about to finish. Abu •Ubaydah ordered us to collect all the food for our journey, and it was collected in two bags of dates. Abu ‘Ubaydah kept on giving us our daily ration in small amounts from it, until it was exhausted. The share of each of us used to be one date only.” 1 (one of the narrators from Jabir) said, “How could one date suffice for you?” Jabir replied, “We came to know its value when even that finished.” Jabir added, “When we reached the seashore, we saw a huge fish which was like a small mountain. The army ate from it for eighteen days. Then Abu ‘Ubaydah ordered that two of its ribs be affixed in the ground. Then he ordered that a she-camel be ridden, and it passed under the two ribs (forming an arch) without touching them.”¹²¹ This Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahths)³ ^ Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, “A man asked Allah’s Messenger, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! We go to sea and carry little water with us. If we use it for Wudu’, we get thirsty, so should we use seawater for Wudu?’ The Messenger of Allah jg said, ‘its water is pure and its dead are lawful’,”¹⁴¹ The two Imams, Ash-Shafi’i and Ahmad bin Hanbal, recorded this Hadith, along with the Four Sunan compilers. Al-Bukhari, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Hibban graded it SahOj.. This Hadith was also recorded from the Prophet sg by several other Companions.¹⁵¹ 111 At-Jabari 11 :72,73. 121 Al-Muwatta’ 2 :930 131 Fath Al-Bari 5 : 152 , Muslim 3 : 1535 141 Al-Muwatta’ 1 :22 151 Musnad Ash-Shafi’i no 25, Ahmad 2:238, Abu Dawud no.83, At- Tirmidhi no. 69, An-Nas&’i 1:50, Ibn Majah no. 386, Ibn Khuzaymah no . 1 1 1 , Ibn Hibbfin no . 119.

Hunting Land Game is Prohibited During Ihram Allah said, U ^if Aji ‘fQ. ibut forbidden is land game as long as you are in a state of Ihram.> Therefore, hunting land game during Ihram is not allowed, and if someone who is in the state of ihram hunts, he will have to pay expiation, along with the sin he earns if he does it intentionally. If he hunts by mistake, he will have to pay the expiation and is not allowed to eat from it, because this type of game is just like dead animals, be he a Muhrim or a non- Muhrim. If someone who is not in the state of Ihram hunts and gives the food to a Muhrim, the Muhrim is not allowed to eat from its meat if it was killed for him in particular. As-Sah bin Jathth&mah said that he gave a zebra as a gift to the Prophet M in the area of Waddan or Abwa’, the Prophet jg gave it back. When the Prophet saw the effect of his returning the gift on As-Sah’s face, he said, uf id* ll’J jj up aWe only gave it back to you because we are in a state of Ihram . This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahxhs.ll] The Prophet thought that As-Sah hunted the zebra for him, and this is why he refused to take it. Otherwise, the Muhrim is allowed to eat from the game if one who is not in Ihram hunts it. For when Abu Qatadah hunted a zebra when he was not a Muhrim and offered it to those who were in the state of Ihram, they hesitated to eat from it. They asked the Messenger of Allah jg and he said, Ji

jU-1 'fh* l>\s Jin •Did any of you point at it or help kill it?» They said, “No.” He said, m A1 Bukhari no. 1825,2573, Muslim 2:850.

275 Surah 5. Al-Ma'utah Oft) - 99) (Purl-7) • I uThen cat,'> and he also ate from it. This Hadith is also in the Two Sahths with various wordings.' [Ibn Kathlr only mentioned Ayat 96 to 99 here and explained the better part of Ayah number 96, but he did not mention

the explanation of the rest of that Ayat or the other Ayat (97

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1597–1630]

to 99). This is the case in all of the copies of his Tafsir in existence, and he might have forgotten to do that, for it is less likely that all who copied this book forgot to copy only this part. So we used a summary of the Tafsir of these Ayat from the Imam of Tafsir, Ibn Jarir At-Tabari. We tried to summarize At-Tabari's eloquent words to the best of our ability, by Allah's help and leave.] iAnd have Taqiva of Allah to Whom you shall be gathered back.} Allah says, fear Allah, O people, and beware of His might, by obeying what He commands you and avoiding what He prohibits for you in these Ayat revealed to your Prophet Hg. These Ayat forbid Khamr, gambling, Al-Ansab and Al-Azlam, along with hunting land game and killing it while in the state of Ihram. To Allah will be your return and destination, and He will punish you for disobeying Him and will reward you for obeying Him. iJi \2j '(££\$ szit & fc-} iAllah has made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of security and benefits for mankind,} Allah says, Allah made the Ka'bah, the Sacred House, an asylum of safety for the people who have no chief to prevent the strong from transgressing against the weak, the evil from the good-doers, and the oppressors from the oppressed. iAnd also the Sacred Month and the animals of offerings and 111 Fath Al-Bari 9 : 528 , Muslim 2 :362

276 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir the garlanded.> Allah says that He made these symbols an asylum of safely for the people, just as He made the Ka'bah an asylum of safety for them, so that He distinguishes them from each other, for this is their asylum and symbol for their livelihood and religion. Allah made the Ka'bah, the Sacred Month, the Hady, the garlanded animals and people an asylum of safety for the Arabs who used to consider these symbols sacred. Thus, these symbols were just like the chief who is obeyed by his followers, and who upholds harmony and public safety. As for the Ka'bah, it includes the entire sacred boundary. Allah termed it “Haram” because He prohibited hunting its game and cutting its trees or grass. Similarly, the Ka'bah, the Sacred Month, the animals of offerings and the garlands were the landmarks of existing Arabs. These symbols were sacred during the time of Jahiliyyah and the people's affairs were guided and protected by them. With Islam they became the symbols of their Hajj, their rituals, and the direction of the prayer, [i.e., the Ka'bah in Makkah.J 4 US 4 U jt 3 ithat you may know that Allah has knowledge of all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth, and that Allah is the All-Knower of each and everything .> Allah says; O people, I made these symbols an asylum for you, so that you know that He Who made these symbols that benefit your life and provide you with security, also knows eveiything in the heavens and earth that brings about your immediate or eventual benefit. Know that He has perfect knowledge of everything and that none of your deeds or affairs ever escapes His observation; and He will count them for you so that He rewards those who do good with the same and those who do evil in kind. { J>> < r-> jj** &% yllji 4Know that Allah is severe in

punishment and that Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .> Allah says, know that your Lord, Who has perfect knowledge of whatever is in the heavens and earth, and Who is never

unaware of your deeds - public or secret - is severe in punishment for those who disobey and defy Him. He also pardons the sins of those who obey and repent to Him, more Merciful than to punish them for the sins that they repented from. 2 CS £ pt% gj('ll Jgjf& £} iThe Messenger's duty is but to convey. And Allah knows all that you reveal and all that you conceal.} This is a warning from Allah for His servants in which He says: Our Messenger, whom We sent to you, has only to convey Our Message and then the reward for the obedience, and punishment for the disobedience is on Us. The obedience of those who accept Our Message never escapes Our knowledge, just as in the case of those who disobey and defy Our Message. We know what one of you does, demonstrates physically, announces, and utters with his tongue, and what you hide in your hearts, be it of faith, disbelief, certainty, doubt or hypocrisy. He Who is so capable, then nothing that the hearts conceal, nor any of the apparent acts of the souls in the heavens and earth could escape His knowledge. In His Hand, alone, is the reward and punishment, and He is worthy to be feared, obeyed and never disobeyed. JjbC iif ijijfi V & *\$2P '4 Cl ;'CS \p£ p % Uib 13 %&%&P2 4 >' 1^ . \y£yj\ jJ> Jt 4100. Say : "Not equal are the bad things and the good things, even though the abundance of the bad may please you So have Taqwa ofAllah, O men of understanding in order that you may be successful.} 4101. O you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble. But ifyou ask about them lohile the Qur'an is being revealed, they will be made plain to you. Allah has forgiven that, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing.} 4102. Before you, a community asked such questions, then on that account they became disbelievers.}

Allah says to His Messenger jg, 4Say,} O Muhammad jg\$, 4'A***^ Jj) Sj—> 'i} \$Not equal are the bad things and the good things, even though they may please you O human, \$the abundance of bad.} This Ayah means, the little permissible is better than the abundant evil. 4.—ijiV' Taqwd ofAllah, O men ofunderstanding . . .} who have sound minds, avoid and abandon the impermissible, and let the permissible be sufficient for you, 4in order that you may be successful.} in this life and the Hereafter. Unnecessary Questioning is Disapproved of Allah said next, 4pp>p Xz oljO £y£S* Ip: £&\ 40 you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble.} This Ayah refers to good conduct that Allah is teaching His believing servants, by forbidding them from asking about useless things. Since if they get the answers they sought, they might be troublesome for them and difficult on their ears. Al- Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said, "The Messenger of Allah Sg gave a speech unlike anything I heard before. In this speech, he said, "Ij\$ ij^ iSpj , 'pS U bjPc> ^Ifyou but know what I know, you will laugh little and cry a

The companions of Allah's Messenger jg covered their faces and the sound of crying was coming out of their chests. A man asked, 'Who is my father?' The Prophet jg said, 'So-and-so'. This Ayah was later revealed, iAsk not about things... Muslim, Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal recorded this HadithJ2 ' Ibn Jarir recorded that Qatadah said about Allah's statement, , . _ iO you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble.} Anas bin Malik narrated that once, the people were questioning the Messenger of Allah jg until they made him angry. So he ascended the Minbarand said. nYou will not ask me about anytltting today but I will explain it to you. So the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg feared that it was the commencement of a momentous event,

and I looked to my right and left and found only people who covered their faces, crying. An argumentative man who was said to be the son of someone other than his true father asked, “O Allah’s Messenger! Who is my father? The Prophet jg said, ‘Your father is Hudhafah.’” ‘Umar stood up (when he saw anger on the Prophet’s face) and said, “We accept Allah as our Lord, Islam as our religion and Muhammad sg as our Messenger, I seek refuge with Allah from the evil of the Fitan (trials in life and religion).” The Messenger of Allah said, ^>3> J 1 j> •LsUJI -J U4^3 3&’3 ^*3’ iJ f_fc3^ 111 Fath Al-B&ri 8:130. 121 Fath Al-Bari 11:326, Muslim 4:1832, Ahmad 3:180, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi8 :42 1 , Tuhfat Al-Ashraf 1 :413

«/ have never witnessed both goodness and evil like I have today. Paradise and the Fire were shown to me and I saw them before that wall.^ 1 ^ This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahihs from Said.121 Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Some people used to question the Messenger of Allah ^ to mock him. One of them would ask, ‘Who is my father,’ while another would ask, “Where is my camel,’ when he lost his camel. Allah sent down this Ayah about them, p2 of £ y£S V \pd <,if \$£> 40 you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble... Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali said, “When this Ayah was revealed, S? jy? & A,i} 4And Hajj to the House is a duty that mankind owes to Allah, those who can bear thejourney.}[3:97], they asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Is it required every year?’ He did not answer them, and they asked again, Is it every year?’ He still did not answer them, so they asked. Is it every year?’ He said, » ui 3p :Us Aj i^» “No, and had I said 'yes', it would have become obligated, and had it become obligated, you would not be able to bear it. Allah sent down, ipi P'4aK& ip: 40 you who believe! Ask not about things which, ifmade plain to you, may cause you trouble.}.” At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah also recorded this HadithJ4 The apparent wording of this Ayah indicates that we are forbidden At-Tabari 11 :!00. 121 Fath Al-Bari 13 :47 , Muslim 4 :1834 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :130 Ahmad 1 :1 13, At-Tirmidhi no. 3055, Ibn Majah no. 2884.

to ask about things that if one has knowledge of, he would be sorry he had asked. Consequently, it is better to avoid such questions. Allah’s statement, & yss iBut ifyou ask about them while the Qur'an is being revealed, they will be made plain to you.} means, if you ask about things that you are prohibited from asking about, then when the revelation about them comes to the Messenger jg, they will be made plain for you, 4%?. & Mj} iVerily! That is easyfor Allah.} Allah said next, 61} iAllah has forgiveti that,} what you did before this, iflf jy iand Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Forbearing.} Do not ask about things that do not have a ruling yet, for because of your questions, a difficult ruling may be ordained. A Hadlth states, djdlU J>-i ja Yj>6 '•’fyA. ^ If jk* "J «77ie worst criminal among the Muslims is he who asks if a matter is unlawful (or not), and it becomes unlawful because of his asking about if .»*** It is recorded in the Sahlh that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 1_j1p i'fs '{SXS JIS ja Jllel JyS *Leave me as I have left you, those before you were destroyed because of many questions and disputing with their Prophets."™ An authentic Hadlth also states, * Al-Bukh&ri no. 7289, Muslim no. 2358. 121 Muslim 4:1831.

282 Tafoir ton Kathir \mm "To s#\p:'J\£k0 \$" ***'-« ^ j&y} >> Jtf ai M» .< ff . > •> i j*V , . . - c£jj ' oijA^102 Cji>***j*(Vs— ^*- f < *>*-’•< i (jojJlu^Aj 5JLu*i j _V- 0I4ttu <jl 1 —^ • -bUl’jJIXU'.U'.j l*r-iLjl- gi I’j-^*^ „ A a - J^V 4)ii yu() . * * > a v v - v > * ". > 7:UjJl^ J-?“J i LftjJLyAt yj »UJ#f t lijJLU *Ai »U«if oiwj t li jl~lu jjr J «iEp ijili: 1Allah, the Most Honored, has ordained some obligations, so do

not ignore them; has set some limits, so do not trespass them; has prohibited some things, so do not commit them; and has left some things without rulings, out of mercy for you, not that He forgot them, so do not ask about them. Allah said next. *oi f} Cifti aj*> iBefore you, a community asked such questions, then on that account they became disbelievers meaning, some people before your time asked such questions and they were given answers. They did not believe the answers, so they became disbelievers because of that. This occurred because these rulings were made plain to them, yet they did not benefit at all from that, for they asked about these things not to gain guidance, but only to mock and defy. >at \$ Cufiii \fjt &! fogfi 3j fcffo HI Al-Bukhari 4623 and Muslim 2856.

ijUj jIS&\$ t jl iiju; ji lilj JpO&J 4VHyiyJSp Yj V jl\$ tsiLL. #4 L> t 1 *-'*>- 4103. Allah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham. But those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most of them have no understanding.} 4104. And when it is said to them : "Come to what Allah has revealed and unto the Messenger." They say: "Enough for us is that which we found our fathers following," even though their fathers had no knowledge whatsoever and no guidance.} The Meaning of Bahirah, Sa'ibah, Wasilah and Ham Al-Bukhari recorded that Said bin Al-Musayyib said, "The Bahirah is a female camel whose milk was spared for the idols and no one was allowed to milk it. The Sa'ibah is a female camel let loose for free pasture for the idols, and nothing was allowed to be carried on it. Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, >A J i * Ji'- y. js i, ;!>Ul </ saw 'Amr bin 'Amir Al-Khuzd'i pulling his intestines behind him in the Fire, and he was the first to start the practice of Sd'ibah .»[11 As for the Wasilah, it is a female camel set free for the idols, because it had given birth to a she-camel in its first delivery and then another she-camel at its second delivery. They used to set such camel free if she gave birth to two females without a male between them. As for the fiam, it is a male camel which would be freed from work for the idols, after it had finished a number of copulations assigned for it. The male camel freed from work in this case is called a HamL ***21 Muslim and An-Nasal131 recorded this Hadith. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that *** Al-Bayhaqi 10:12. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 8:133. ^ Muslim 4 :2192 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :338

the Prophet said, *i/IJ Ji 3j** y} fliiSII xSj Cli [ly Jji d)8 fijlljl o»ULol a*The first to start the practice of Sd'ibah and worshipping idols was Abu Khuzd'ah, 'Amr bin 'Amir. I saw him pulling his intestines behind him in the Fire." The 'Amr mentioned in the above Hadith is the son of Luhay bin Qam'ah, one of the chiefs of the tribe of Khuza'ah who were the caretakers of the House of Allah after the tribe of Jurhum, (and before the Prophet's jg tribe, Quraysh). He was the first to change the religion of Ibrahim (Al-KhaM in Makkah) bringing idol worshipping to the area of Hijaz (Western Arabia). He also called the foolish people to worship idols and offer sacrifices to them and started these ignorant rituals concerning the animals as well as other rituals of Jdhiliyyah. Allah said in Surat Al-An'am, ^2% cSi k iAnd they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. .^(3:136J. As for the Bahirah, 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "It is the female camel that has given delivery five times. After that, they looked at the fifth delivery, if it were a male, they would slaughter it and give it to the men only and not the women. If it were a female, they would cut off its ears and proclaim, This is a Bahirah (no one is allowed to milk it).""121 As-Suddi and others mentioned a similar statement.131 As for the S&'ibah, Mujahid said that it is for sheep, and mentioned a similar meaning as for Bahirah. He said that it delivers six females and then a male, female or two males, and that they then would slaughter it (the newly born sheep) and feed its meat to the men, but not to the woman.*4'

Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the Sa'ibah is the female [1 * Ahmad 1 :446. ' At-Tabari 11 :129. At-Tabari 11:130. *41 At-Tabari 11 :128.

camel that delivers ten females, without giving birth to a single male between them. They would then set it free and no one was allowed to ride it, cut its wool or milk it, except for a guest. Abu Rawq said, "The Sa'ibah was made as such when one goes out for some of his affairs and succeeds in whatever he intended to do. So he would designate a Sa'ibah from his property, a female camel or another type, and would set it free for the idols (in appreciation for his success). Then, whatever this camel gave birth to was set free for the idols too." As- Suddi said, "When one's affair was successful, or if he was cured from an illness, or if his wealth increased, he would set some of his wealth free for the idols. Those who would try to acquire any of the Sa'ibah property were punished in this world." As for the WasOah, 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "It is the sheep that gives birth seven times, if she gives birth to a male or a female stillborn at its seventh delivery, the men, but not the women, would eat from it. If she gave birth to a female, or a female and a male, they would set them free, proclaiming (about the male in this case). His sister Wasalat (literally, 'connected him to being forbidden on us)." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement . 111 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Az-Zuhri said that Said bin Al-Musayyib said that, I'M iOr a Wastlah} "It is the female camel that gives delivery to a female and then another female at its second delivery. They would call such a camel a Wasilah, proclaiming that she has Wasalat (connected) between two females without giving birth to a male between them. So they used to cut off the ears of the WasOah and let it roam free to pasture for their idols."*21 A similar explanation was reported from Imam Malik bin Anas. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "The WasOah sheep is the ewe that gives birth to ten females in five deliveries, giving birth to two females at each delivery. This sheep would be called 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1222. 'Abdur-Razzaq 1:196.

WasUah and would be set free. Whatever this sheep delivers afterwards, male or female, would be given to the men, but not the women, but if it delivers a stillborn, men and women would share it!" As for the Ham, Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "If a man's camel performs ten copulations, they would call him a Ham, 'So set him free.,'"1 * 1 Similar was reported from AbuRawq and Qatadah. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Ham is the male camel whose offspring gave birth to their own offspring; they would then proclaim, This camel has Hama (protected) its back.' Therefore, they would not carry anything on this male camel, cut his wool, prevent him from grazing wherever he likes or drinking from any pool, even if the pool did not belong to its owner."121 Ibn Wahb said, "I heard Malik saying, 'As for the Ham, it is the male camel who is assigned a certain number of copulations, and when having finished what was assigned to him, would have peacock feathers placed on him and be set free.'" Other opinions were also mentioned to explain this Ayah. There is a Hadith on this subject that Ibn Abi Hatim collected from Abu Ishaq As-Subay'i from Al-Ahwas Al- Jushami from his father Malik bin Nadlah who said, "I came to the Prophet jg wearing old clothes. So he said to me, «?JU -j. id «Do you have any property?t I said, 'Yes.' He asked, aWhat type?n I said, 'All types; camels, sheep, horses and slaves.' He said, <idi fii vu iiM «// Allah gives you wealth, then let it show on you .» He then asked, blj iiy •Do your catnels deliver calves that have full ears?* I said, "Yes, At-Tabari 11:129. Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :1225

and do camels give birth but to whole calves?' He said, 'Yes.' He said, 'Then do not do that, for all the wealth that Allah has given you is allowed for you.' » Then he said; 'Allah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham.' As for the Bahirah, it is the animal whose ears were cut, one would not allow his wife, daughters, or any of his household to benefit from its wool, hair or milk. But, if it died, they would share it. As for the Sa'ibah, they used to set it free for their idols and announce this fact in the vicinity of the idols. As for the Wasilah, it is the sheep that gives birth to six offspring. When she delivered for the seventh time, they would cut its ears and horns, saying, "It has Wasalat (connected deliveries)," and they would not slaughter it, hit it or prevent it from drinking from any pool."11 This Hadith was narrated with the addition of the explanation of these words in it. In another narration for this Hadith from Abu Ishaq from Abu Al-Ahwas, 'Awf bin Malik used his own words (Le., he explained these words not as a part of the Hadith itself) and this is more sound. Imam Ahmad recorded this Hadith from Sufyan bin Thayyib, from Abu Az-Za'ayri 'Amr bin 'Amr, from his uncle Abu Al-Ahwas 'Awf bin Malik bin Nadlah from his father, Malik bin Nadlah.12' This narration also does not contain the explanation of Bahirah, Ham etc., that is added to the Hadith above, and Allah knows best. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1220. ' Ahmad 4 :136.

Allah's statement, 'And those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most of them have no understanding.' means, Allah did not legislate these invented rituals and He does not consider them acts of obedience. Rather, it is the idolaters who made them into rituals and acts of worship that they used to draw near to Allah. But they did not and will not help them to draw near to Him, rather, these innovations will only harm them. And when it is said to them: "Come to what Allah has revealed and to the Messenger." They say; "Enough for us is that which we found our fathers following," meaning, if they are called to Allah's religion, Law and commandments and to avoiding what He prohibited, they say, The ways and practices that we found our fathers and forefathers following are good enough for us. ' Allah said, 'even though their fathers had no knowledge whatsoever...' That is, even though their fathers did not understand or recognize the truth or find its way. Therefore, who would follow their forefathers, except those who are even more ignorant and misguided than they were? O you who believe! Take care of yourselves. If you follow the right guidance, no hurt can come to you from those who are in error. The return of you all is to Allah, then He will inform you about (all) that you used to do.' One is Required to Reform Himself First Allah commands His believing servants to reform themselves and to do as many righteous deeds as possible. He also informs them that whoever reforms himself, he would not be

affected by the wickedness of the wicked, whether they were his relatives or otherwise. Imam Ahmad recorded that Qays said, "Abu Bakr As-Siddiq stood up, thanked Allah and praised Him and then said, 'O people! You read this Ayah, 'O you who believe! Take care of yourselves. If you follow the right guidance, no hurt can come to you from those who are in error.' You explain it the wrong way. I heard the Messenger of Allah say, 'If the people witness evil and do not change it, then Allah is about to send His punishment to encompass them. I (Qays) also heard Abu Bakr say, 'O people! Beware of lying, for lying contradicts faith.'"111 'O people! Beware of lying, for lying contradicts faith.'"111 'O people! Beware of lying, for lying contradicts faith.'"111

bi ui) liiiLlt Cfit jff j« SJ i!| *uf *L Cj fafa * Vfa M ofa ^jVf^ ££11 *if /fc> O'.J *";£ t #« 7/ // X "i.f « •'** / " , 'fv / ,# > . i / CHJ o' jl \y> J 4 Y Si'j [ji—'j Ijli \ju'j 4106. O you who believe! When death approaches any of you, and you make a bequest, then take the testimony of two just men of your own folk or two others from outside, if you are traveling through the land and the calamity of death befalls you. Detain them both after the Saldh (the prayer), (then) if you are in doubt (about their truthfulness), let them both swear by Allah (saying): “We wish not for any worldly gain in this, even though he (the beneficiary) be our near relative. We shall m Ahmad 1 :5.

not hide the testimony of Allah, for then indeed we should be of the sinful.”} 4107. If it then becomes known that these two had been guilty of sin, let two others stand forth in their places, nearest in kin from among those who claim a lawful right. Let them swear by Allah (saying): “We affirm that our testimony is truer than that of both of them, and that we have not trespassed (the truth), for then indeed we should be of the wrongdoers.”} 4108. That should make it closer (to the fact) that their testimony would be in its true nature and shape, or else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted after their oaths. And have Taqwa of Allah and listen (with obedience to Him). And Allah guides not the rebellious people.} Testimony of Two Just Witnesses for the Final Will and Testament This honorable Ayah contains a glorious ruling from Allah. Allah’s statement, 4\$\$\$ Up £'• 1\$ 40 you who believe! When death approaches any of you, and you make a bequest, then take the testimony of two...} meaning that there should be two witnesses in such cases, 4just men...} thus, describing them as just, 4of your own folk} Muslims, oj %>'>' 3^ 4or two others from outside} non-Muslims, meaning the People of the Book, according to Ibn ‘Abbas as Ibn Abi Hatim recorded. Allah said next, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 12:1229.

291 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (105 - 108) (Part-7) if you are traveling through the land on a journey, } and the calamity of death befalls you.} These are two conditions that permit using non-Muslims from among the Dhimmis for witnesses when there are no Muslims present: When one is traveling and needs to write a will, as Sharih Al-Qadi said. Ibn Jarir recorded that Sharih said, “The witness of the Jews and Christians is not allowed except while traveling, and even then only to witness the dictation of the will.” Allah’s statement, iDetain them both after the Saldh (the prayer),} refers to the 'Asr prayer, according to Al-‘Awfi who reported it from Ibn ‘Abbas.*2 This is the same explanation reported from Said bin Jubayr, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Qatadah, ‘Ikrimah and Muhammad bin Sirin. As for Az-Zuhri, he said that they are detained after Muslim prayer (i.e., in congregation). 13 Therefore, these two witnesses will be detained after a congregational prayer, 4Z3 o\A oCJZ} 4let than both swear by Allah if you are in doubt.} meaning, if you are in doubt that they might have committed treachery or theft, then they should swear by Allah, 4We wish not in this} in our vows, according to Muqatil bin Hayyan. 4u} if for any worldly gain} of this soon to end life, 3Vj} ieven though he be our near relative.} meaning, if the beneficiaiy m At-Tabari 11 :163,164. At-Tabari 11 :172. At-Tabari 11 :174.

293 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (105 - 108) (Part-7) honor. This is discussed in the studies of the oaths in the books of Ahk&m. Allah’s statement, £ \s%d\ \% J HA \$>} iThat should make it closer (to tiiefact) that their testi- mony would be in its true nature and shape (and thus accepted),} means, the ruling requiring the two Dhimmi witnesses to swear, if there is a doubt that they were not truthful, might compel them to admit to the testimony in its true form. Allah’s statement, feU ior else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted after their oaths.} means, requiring them to swear by Allah might encourage

them to admit to the true testimony because they respect swearing by Allah and they glorify and revere Him. They also fear exposure if the heirs of the deceased are required to swear instead of them. In this case, the heirs would swear and earn the rightful inheritance that the two witnesses failed to declare. This is why Allah said, *fe' j 1* } ior else they would fear that (other) oaths would be admitted W53H1& saaiEU ^Jr ^ h jlk V l j fez > > *• • /•^ » v* * * * " + ; * > • t T ^ / • . at • J/' • O' OSVjri??

295 Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (109 - 111) (Part-7) 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ath-Thawri said that Al-A'mash said that Mujahid said about the Ayah, A TiC US iOn the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them : "What was the response you received?" } They will become afraid and reply, 4U jk 4We have no knowledge .. ^ Ibn Jarir*2 * and Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded this explanation. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, ti 'a sc lit £4 iOn the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them: "What was the response you received (from men to your teaching)?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, verily, only You are the Knower of all that is hidden." } "They will say to the Lord, Most Honored, 'We have no knowledge beyond what we know, and even that. You have more knowledge of them than us.'"*3 * This response is out of respect before the Lord, Most Honored, and it means, we have no knowledge compared to Your encompassing knowledge. Therefore, our knowledge only grasped the visible behavior of these people, not the secrets of their hearts. You are the Knower of everything, Who has encompassing knowledge of all things, and our knowledge compared to Your knowledge is similar to not having any knowledge at all, for 4V£X&^} ionly You are the Knower of all that is hidden.} *** 'Abdur-Razzaq 1:201. At-Tabari 11:210. At-Tabari 11:211.

iiij J-4V'j P4=J' -±£& >i> j-P" ^ J\lSrf %z **• iff i *r, h'x > yy . '< . r» . ""s' st ' ' >y,' - 'K*.£L^=*i\ Sjjy 1/y* IJj jjJaN 4i: |S ^ h PtPi & 3>k Apr^ & 3% 3 s^pr ji^ iu #sip *i >ii 4£ up yr 3ui ^jv 4110. (Remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Remember My favor to you and to your mother when I supported you with Ruh - il- Qudus [fibril] so that you spoke to the people in the cradle and in maturity; and when I taught you the Book, the Hikmah, the Tawrah and the Injil; and when you made out of the clay, as it were, the figure of a bird, by My permission, and you breathed into it, and it became a bird by My permission, and you healed those born blind, and the lepers by My permission, and when you brought forth the dead by My permission; and when I restrained the Children of Israel from you since you came unto them with clear proofs, and the disbelievers among them said: 'This is nothing but evident magic 4111. "And when I Awhaytu [put in the hearts of] Al-Hawariyyin to believe in Me and My Messenger, they said: We believe. And bear witness that we are Muslims."*4 Reminding 'Isa of the Favors that Allah Granted him Allah mentions how He blessed His servant and Messenger, Isa, son of Maryam, and the miracles and extraordinary acts He granted him. Allah said, 4Remember My favor to you^ when I created you from your mother, without male intervention, and made you a sign and clear proof of My perfect power over all things. 4And to your mother when I made you testify to her chastity and you thus absolved her from the sin that the unjust, ignorant liars accused her of,

iw when I supported you with Ruh - il-Qudus^ the angel Jibril, and made you a Prophet, calling to Allah in the cradle and manhood. I made you speak in the cradle, and you testified that your mother was free from any immoral behavior, and you proclaimed that you worship Me. You also conveyed the news

of My Message and invited them to worship Me. so that you spoke to the people in the cradle and in maturity Meaning you called the people to Allah in childhood and in maturity. And the word Tukallim means invited, because his speaking to people while a child is nothing strange by itself. Allah's statement, iiXJSj iAnd when I taught you the Book and the Hikmah,\$ the power of writing and understanding, iand the Tawrdh which was revealed to Musa, son of Imran, who spoke to Allah directly. Allah's statement, iand when you made out of the clay, as it were, thefigure of a bird, byMy permission means: 'you shaped it in the figure of a bird by My permission, and it became a bird with My permission, after you blew into it'. Then, it became a flying bird with a soul by Allah's permission. Allah said; <#h iand you healed those bom blind, and the lepers by My permission, This was explained before in Surah Al 'Imran (chapter 3) and we do not need to repeat it here. Allah's statement,

299Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (112 - 115) (Part-7 mum uv .tUli '|C<r'o .'cr*!£ jJ@ ijuy^do-*^ /* ^ \ l t?' > 40*^(^Cu •* ^ ^ X* />* I 'j I * I J tii JSStajJ Ca i^5"j ft^VJj4jii' <^E^<jV""^**^ ^ ' f!-^ ' =^ g&iJWS\$ MIkJIjjyd 1^Kx'y*J5pr*4JJ l ^ 4And your Lord Awha (inspired) the bee, say- ing: "Take habitations in the mountains and in the trees and in what they erect. Then, eat of all fruits, and follow the ways of your Lord made easy (for you)."} [16:68-69] Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented about the Hawariyyun, "Allah inspired them", while As-Suddi said, "He put in their hearts," and the Hawariyyun said, 4Sj4li &W} iWe believe. And bear witness that we are Muslims.} 5jj£ji JU ij> ^4 ji S' j\ jLy >jJj iSspofeti* j,* • £-=» <&' IjiJi Jli .uLi)' »-vX* ty* Jjo S '— Jtt iggc^j Oi oj^j j5 jl j^L«jj Ljjj& J^=^J 5J»j t^l»j LJjV 'j— LJ j -I- '-* SjJl* Sf Ujj Ja-tlll i?) ts"i!5 tjjj j* Jli f£He 4\ . iif jfi j?- «i*t» <5*4 Si 'SJ 'Sf tu* /Jjj 4122. (Remember) when Al-Hawdriyun said: "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Can your Lord send down to us a Ma'idah from heaven?" 'Isa said: "Have Taqwa of Allah, if you are indeed believers."} 4113. They said: "We wish to eat thereof and to be stronger in faith, and to know that you have indeed told us the truth and

that we ourselves be its witnesses."} }114. 'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Allah, our Lord! Send us from heaven a table spread (with food) that there may be for us - for the first and the last of us - a festival and a sign from You; and provide us sustenance, for You are the Best of sustainers."} 4115. Allah said: "I am going to send it down unto you, but if any of you after that disbelieves, then I will punish him with a torment such as I have not inflicted on anyone among the 'Alamin."} SendingDown the Ma'idah This is the story of the Ma'idah, the name of which this Surah bears, Surat Al-Ma'idah. This is also among the favors that Allah granted His servant and Messenger, Isa, accepting his request to send the Ma'idah down, and doing so as clear proof and unequivocal evidence. Allah said, 44/^ ja Si» 4(Retnember) when Al-Hawaryun said...} the disciples of Isa said, 40 'Isa, son of Maryam! Can your Lord send down to us a Ma'idahfrom heaven?} The Ma'idah is the table that has food on it. Some scholars said that the disciples requested this table because they were poor and deprived. So they asked Isa to supplicate to Allah to send a table of food down to them that they could eat from every day and thus be more able to perform the acts of worship. / »a a > m p* ittl ijil JUy 4'Isa said: "Have Taqwa ofAllah, ifyou are indeed believers."} "Isa answered them by saying, 'Have Taqwa of Allah! And do not ask for this, for it may become a trial for you, but trust in Allah for your provisions, ifyou Eire truly believers.'

4They said: "We wish to eat thereof."} we need to eat from it, iatid to be stronger in faith,\$ when we witness it descending from heaven as sustenance for us, i&Z. 3 i5pj} 4and to know that you have

indeed told us the truth,} of your Message and our faith in you increases and also our knowledge, iand that we ourselves be its witnesses. testifying that it is a sign from Allah, as proof and evidence that you are a Prophet, and attesting to the truth of what you brought us, Qft ii* U Alin & & '4 % ^ i'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Allah, our Lord! Send us from heaven a table spread (with food) that there may befor us - for thefirst and the last ofus - a festival..."} As-Suddi commented that the Ayah means, "We will take that day on which the table was sent down as a day of celebration, that we and those who come after us would consider sacred."111 Sufyan Ath-Thawri said that it means, "A day of prayer."121 4Jbi ty*j} iand a sign from You.} proving that You are able to do all things and to accept my supplication, so that they accept what I convey to them from You, iand provide us sustenance,} a delicious food from You that does not require any effort or hardship, 111 At-Tabari 11 :225. 121 At-Tabari 11 :225.

f^6 d.\ iif JB C&j} 4"For You are the Best of sustainers." Allah said: "I am going to send it down unto you, but if any of you after that disbelieves..."} by denying this sign and defying its implication, O Isa, 4*&\ ss V Q& ithen I will punish him with a torment such as I have not inflicted on anyone among the 'Alatmn .} among the people ofyour time. Allah said in similar Ayat, i^\Zs\ lit X fci£il tfe }yj} 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Cause Fir'awn's people to mter the severest tortnent!"} [40:46], and, iVerily, the hypocrites will be in the lowest depths of the Fire.} [4:145] Ibn Jarir said that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "Those who will receive the severest torment on the Day of Resurrection are three: The hypocrites, those from the people of Al-Ma'idah who disbelieved in it, and the people of Fir'awn."* 11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They said to Isa, son of Maiyam, 'Supplicate to Allah to send down to us from heaven, a table spread with food.' He also said, 'So the angels brought the table down containing seven fish and seven pieces of bread and placed it before them. So the last group of people ate as the first group did.'"121 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ishaq bin 'Abdullah said that the table was sent down to Isa son of Maryam having seven pieces of bread and seven fish, and they ate from it as much as they wished. But when some of them stole food from it, saying, "It might not come down tomorrow," the table ascended.131 At-Tabari 11:233. 121 At-Tabari 5 :132 , Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :1246 131 At-Tabari 5:134.

These statements testify that the table was sent down to the Children of Israel during the time of Isa, son of Maryam, as a result of Allah's accepting his supplication to Him. The apparent wording of this Ayah also states so, 41& 4Allah said: "I am going to send it down unto you..." (5:1 15]. jfi jif o/j Ji a' i >£) (L ^Ju ^ -xi* jCU ^ U Jy» o' Q Ojr** v* tit***— iil (jl oil U pllfr O^ < 1 4 U V> fe. o4j ^,Uc 0-1 llli i~*i U 'o-j— ooSj ^2jJ jj #3' £&\$\$\$%* 4>^5 pr£ (*& *1 y 4116. And (remember) when Allah will say (on the Day of Resurrection): "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Did you say unto men : Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?" He will say : "Glory be to You! It was notfor me to say what I had no right (to say). Had I said such a thing. You would surely have known it. You know what is in my inner self though I do not know what is in Yours, truly. You, only You, are the Knower ofall that is hidden and unseen.") 4117. "Never did I say to them ought except what You (Allah) did command me to say: Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord.' And I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them, but when You took me {up}, You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things.") ill8. "IfYou punish them, they are Your servants, and ifYou forgive them, verily You, only You are the Almighty, the All- Wise.") 'Isa Rejects Shirkand Affirms Tawhid Allah will also speak to His

servant and Messenger, Isa son of Maryam, peace be upon him, saying to him on the Day of Resurrection in the presence of those who worshipped Isa and his mother as gods besides Allah, oi ut!j '(if> a' J^*k)

305Surat 5. Al-Mii'idah (116 - 118) <Part-7 nothing escapes Your knowledge. Rather, I have not said these words nor did the thought even cross my mind, this why he, said, U pjl cJb U pSlfr dlyi) t^* 4 ^ 4Yo« fcnoiy what is in my inner selfthough I do not know what is in Yours, truly, You, only You, are the Knower of all that is hidden and unseen . Never did I say to them ought except what You (Allah) did command me to say...} and convey, j; itw# 4Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord.} I only called them to what You sent me with and commanded me to convey to them, j; it & ^Worship Allah, my Lord and your Lord} and this is what I conveyed to them, A •* .S ' , A ,£2 iAnd I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them,} I was a witness over what they did when I was amongst them, il ibut when You took me [up]. You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things.} Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Messenger of Allah jgj stood up once and gave us a speech in which he said, •® 'ily lily tolU- 'y «i>l II «0 people! You will be gathered to Allah while barefooted, naked and uncircumcised;

}As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it.} Iri fji J&i JIjt ulj» U N liUI :Jy(i iJUJJI oli JLi^i jbi ju us jyG ih'j£ The first among the creation who will be covered with clothes will be Ibrahim. Some men from my Ummah will be brought and taken to the left (to the Fire) and I will yell, 'They are my followers!' It will be said, 'You do not know what they innvovated after you (in religion).' So I will say just as the righteous servant (Tsa) said, iAnd I was a witness over them while I dwelled amongst them, but when You took me [up], You were the Watcher over them, and You are a Witness to all things. If You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily You, only You are the Almighty, the All-Wise.} "It will further be said, 'These people kept reverting back on their heels after you left them.'o"W Al-Bukhari*2 ' also recorded this Hadith in the explanation of this Ayah. Allah said; ilf You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily You, only You are the Almighty, the All- Wise.} All matters refer back to Allah, for He does what He Wills and none can question Him about what He does, while He will question them. This Ayah also shows the crime of the ' Musnad At-Tayalisi no . 343 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :135

307Surah 5. Al-Ma'idah (119 - 120) (Part-7) Christians who invented a lie against Allah and His Messenger, thus making a rival, wife and son for Allah. Allah is glorified in that He is far above what they attribute to Him. So this Ayah [5:118] has tremendous value and delivers unique news. Ijj Xfj UJVf- o; iSf £*4 '\$ d® >*J liil 41 jjil' *4\$ lie jjijj li' 4119. Allah will say: "This is a Day on which the truthful will profit from their truth : Theirs are Gardens under which rivers flow (in Paradise) - they shall abide therein forever. Allah is pleased with them and they with Him. That is the great success. 4120. To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is therein, and He is able to do all things.} OnlyTruth willbe ofBenefiton theDay ofResurrection Allah answers His servant and Messenger 'Isa, son of Maiyam, after he disowns the disbelieving Christians who lied about Allah and His Messenger, and when 'Isa refers their end to the will of his Lord, 4This is a Day on which the truthful will profit from their truth.} Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "This is the Day when Tawhid will benefit those who believed in it." 4Tltheirs are Gardens under which rivers flow (in

Paradise) - they shall abide therein forever and they will never be removed from it, 4AUah is pleased with them and they with Him.}

iBut the greatest bliss is the good pleasure ofAllah.} [9:72} We will mention the Hadiths about this Ayah [9:72] later on. Allah's statement, gif&} 4That is the great success.} means, this is the great success, other than which there is no greater success. Allah said* in another Ayat, fis gj} 4For the like of this let the workers work.} [37:61], and, jjGdi iSj'i jj^ 4Andfor this let (all) those strive who want to strive.} [83:26] Allah's statement, 4To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is therein, and He is able to do all things.} means, He created everything, owns everything, controls the affairs of everything and is able to do all things. Therefore, everything and everyone are in His domain and under His power and will. There is none like Him, nor is there rived, ancestor, son, or wife for Him, nor a lord or god besides Him. Ibn Wahb said that he heard Huyay bin 'Abdullah saying that Abu 'Abdur-Rahman Al-Habli said that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "The last revealed Surah was Surat Al-Ma'idah."'^ m At-Tirmidhi no . 3063

Surah 6: Al-Anam

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1631–1634]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-An'am (Chapter - 6) Whichwas Revealed inMakkah ^ ilgaSB&S 'TA ^The Virtue of Surat Al-An'am andWhen itWas Revealed Al-'Awfi, 'Ikrimah and 'Ata' said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Surat Al- An'am was revealed in Makkah ” 1 ' A\$- Tabarani recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "All of Surat Al-An'am was revealed in Makkah at night, accompanied by seventy thousand angels, raising their voices in glorification of Allah"12' As-Suddi said that Murrah said that 'Abdullah said, "Surat Al-An'am was revealed in the company of seventy thousand angels."3' ag» In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3 :243 121 At-Tabarani 12:215. '3| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3 :243

ofo ciikli <i>y« J^ 4U. lEjK _u_2i^ >J /Ai£ J»-l> Jjii ji Cnt I>i c£ii' ji t j&y 'ftAft-i '<&~i pbs 3?J^" jj 4 lit b*J il. All praise be to Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and originated the darkness and the light, yet those who disbelieve hold others as equal with their Lord.} il. He it is Who has created you from clay, and then has decreed a stated term. And there is with Him another determined term, yet you doubt. i3. And He is Allah, in the heavens and the earth. He knows what you conceal and what you reveal, and He knows what you eam.\$> All Praise is Due to Allah for His Glorious Ability and GreatPower Allah praises and glorifies His Most Honorable Self for creating the heavens and earth, as a dwelling for His servants, and for making the darkness and the light to benefit them in the night and the day. In this Ayah, Allah describes darkness in the plural, Zulumat [where Zulmah is singular for darkness], while describing the light in the singular, An-Nur, because An- Nur is more honored. In other Ayat, Allah said. iTo the right and to the left. [16:48] Near the end of this Surah (chapter 6), Allah also said; ^ J?>? Ui ot>^ iAnd verily, this is my straight path, so follow it, and follow no (other) ways, for they will separate you away from His way.\$ [6:153] Allah said next, iYet those who disbelieve hold others as equal with their Lord.\$ meaning, in spite of all this, some of Allah's servants disbelieve in Him and hold others as partners and rivals with Him. Some

of Allah's servants claimed a wife and a son for Allah, hallowed be He far above what they attribute to Him. Allah's statement, M y*} 4He it is Who has created youfrom clay,} refers to the father of mankind, Adam, from whom mankind originated, multiplied in numbers and spread about, east and west. Allah said, 4Then has decreed a stated term. And there is with Him another determined term...} His saying; iThen has decreed a stated term,} refers to death, while, 4And there is with Him another determined term... ^ refers to the Hereafter, according to Said bin Jubayr who reported this from Ibn 'Abbas. * Similar statements were narrated from Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam, 'Atiyyah, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others.*2 * Ibn

'Abbas and Mujahid said that, 4And then has decreed a stated term,} is the term of this earthly life, while, JL3 4And there is with Him another determined term} refers to man's extent of life until he dies as mentioned in Allah's statement;*3 AM JZ? C&£McMaM 4It is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day, m At-Tabari 11:257. * At-Tabari 11 :256-258. * At-Tabari 11 :256.

then He raises (wakes) you up again that a term appointed (life) be fulfilled.} [6:60]

The meaning of Allah's statement,

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AM iWith Him} is that none but Him knows when it will occur. Allah said in other Ayat, IS iThe knowledge thereof is with my Lord. None can reveal its time but He.} [7:187], and. 4They ask you about the Hour - when will be its appointed time? You have no knowledge to say anything about it. To your Lord belongs (the knowledge of) the term thereof.} [79:42-44] Allah said, 4Yet you doubt.} the coming of the (last) Hour, according to As-Suddi. ' Allah said next, 1* jfej 'f&i Jfjt jj 4 iAnd He is Allah in the heavens and the earth, He knows what you conceal and what you reveal, and He knows what you earn.} Meaning, it is He Who is called Allah, throughout the heavens and the earth, that is, it is He who is worshipped, singled out, whose divinity is believed in by the inhabitants of the heavens and the earth. They call Him Allah, and they supplicate to Him in fear and hope, except those who disbelieve among the Jinns and mankind. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ jj sJi 4 jjJ' j*j} ilt is He Who is God in the heavens and the earth.}[43:84] meaning, He is the God of those in heaven and those on earth, m At-Tabari 1 1 :260

323Surah 6. Al-An'dm (4 - 6) (Part-7) and He knows all affairs, public and secret. 4And He knows what you earn£ all the good and bad deeds that you perform. CJ jii .i.vijwJA* (ft- 1 fr^rj Jt jj _*+L» IjJ f i jyf t* (Tri **.»““ (**»W OJ vi/4 bb-li (*^ itHil uLjlj ^3 jiw J L v| 44. And never an Ayah comes to them from the Ayat of their Lord, but that they have been turning awayfrom it.} 45. Indeed, they rejected the truth when it came to them, but there will come to them the news of that which they used to mock at.} 46. Have they not seen how many a generation before them We have destroyed whom We had established on the earth such as We have not established you? And We poured out on them rain from the sky in abundance, and made the rivers flow under them. Yet We destroyed them for their sins, and created after them other generations. Threatening the Idolators for their Stubbornness Allah states that the rebellious, stubborn polytheists will turn away from eveiy Ayah, meaning, sign, miracle and proof that is evidence of Allah's Uniqueness and the truth of His honorable Messengers. They will not contemplate about these Ayat or care about them. Allah said, 4 •*! jyf ijs3 (iiiC- 111 is.^ 4Indeed, they rejected the truth when it came to them, but there will come to them the news of that which they used to mock at.} This Ayah contains a warning and a stem threat for the disbelievers' rejection of the truth, stating that the disbelievers will surely know the truth ofwhat they used to deny and taste the evil end of their behavior. Allah advises and warns the disbelievers, that they should avoid the torments and

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3J~i.j>>y>4* ij_^»~ ' 4-j<-t(J--4 K^i-t jS5j ^ <£«& &a^ -4^ c£«Jt <jt£S ^ ^ ^Vf •* ^ Xft^fiJ4S0i^2t»Sl2 ^ ^ -<< . ,s >.s .,.> •; - -- 4lS^>jj!-^jf •XjU-k^jJA^PcJ^O*Qp y«- S'S*£jN,'J®W^> ./" " <7. And even ifWe /wt 4®S#3f , > t5f < */r-' ,^ ^ .11 M- 7 ^ «uf iL -t. 0)j jv_JllyJ \li^'-JJ.<U-»^> 47. And even ifWe had sent down unto you a Message written on pa- s&***tu^tt'*' c '.*< > S.\i'>#*» ' • Per so thal they con/d <9 <S>*» touch it with their hands, the disbelievers would have said : "This is nothing but obvious magic!"} 48. And they say: "Why has not an angel been sent down to him?" Had We sent down an angel, the matter would have been judged at once, and no respite would be granted to them.} 49. And had We appointed him an angel, We indeed would have made him a man, and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion.} 410. And indeed Messengers were mocked before you, but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at.} 411 . Say: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those who rejected truth."}

316 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Censuring the Rebellious and their Refusal to Accept Human Messengers Allah describes the rebellion and stubbornness of the idolaters in defying the truth and arguing against it, 4And even ifWe had sent down unto you a Message written on paper so that they could touch it with their hands,} meaning, if they saw this Message's descent and were eye- witnesses to that, 4the disbelievers would have said : "This is nothing but obvious magic!"} This is similar to Allah's description of the disbelievers' defiance of facts and truth, j: 'jjy* biii \$j} 4And even ifWe opened to them a gate from the heaven and they were to continue ascending thereto. They would surely say: "Our eyes have been (as if) dazzled. Nay, we are a people bewitched."} [15:14-15], and, *r>£^ Ua 4And if they were to see a piece of the heaven falling down, they would say, "Clouds gathered in heaps!"} [52 : 44]. 4%fc g* 0\ 'yj \)fc} 4And they say: "Why has not an angel been sent down to him?"} to convey the Message with admonition along with him. Allah replied, 2 f & tz (0&} 4Had We sent down an angel, the matter would have been judged at once, and no respite would be granted to them.} Consequently, even if the angels descend, while the

disbelievers still had the same attitude, then the torment will surely befall them from Allah as a consequence. Allah said in other Ayat,)We send not the angels down except with the truth (i.e. for torment, etc.), and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!) (15:8], and, iOn the Day they will see the angels, no glad tidings will there befor the criminals that day.) [25:22] Allah's statement, j. if* bwl+Uj V-»-j)And had We appointed him an angel, We indeed would have made him a man, and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion.) meaning, if We send an angel along with the human Messenger, or if We send an angel as a Messenger to mankind, he would be in the shape of a man so that they would be able to speak to him and benefit from his teachings. In this case, the angel (in the shape of a human) will also cause confusion for them, just as the confusion they caused themselves over accepting humans as Messengers! Allah said, tU dr! '^=4 <0 4& i& iSay: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security. We should certainly have sent down far themfrom the heaven an angel as a Messenger.") (17:95] It is a mercy from Allah to His creation that He sends every type of creation, Messengers from among their kind, so that they are able to call their people to Allah, and their people able to talk to them, ask them and benefit from them. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4 tfs lA 1A> ^ h

318 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ilndeed Allah conferred a greatfavor on the believers when He sent among them a Messengerfrom among themselves, reciting unto them His verses (the Qur'an), and purifying them.} [3:164] Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said about the Ayah [6:9 above], "If an angel was sent to them, he would come in the shape of a man. This is because they will not be able to look at the angel due to light."111 tS 4 • • and We would have certainly caused them confusion in a matter which they have already covered with confusion .} meaning, We would confuse them over their confusion. And Al-Walibi reported Ibn 'Abbas saying; "We brought doubts around them." Allah's statement, 4And indeed Messengers were mocked before you, but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at.} comforts the Messenger jg concerning the denial ofhim by his people. The Ayah also promises the Messenger \$g|, and his believers, of Allah's victory and the good end in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said next. JLi 4 buy 4Say : "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those who rejected truth."} meaning, contemplate about yourselves and think about the afflictions Allah struck the previous nations with, those who defied His Messengers and denied them. Allah sent torment, afflictions and punishment on them in this life, as well as the painful torment in the Hereafter, while saving His Messengers and believing servants. m At-Tabari 11 :268.

4Ji ' *' *I*&^*v* -" -»*& Li a; v L£ ff M» £)> 4^C\$ \$• V ^ • •*. . j <• / » J {{ '•l 412. Say: "To whom belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth?" Say: "To Allah." He has prescribed mercyfor Himself. Indeed He will gather you together on the Day ofResurrection, about which there is no doubt. Those who destroy themselves will not believe.} 413. And to Him belongs whatsoever exists in the night and the day, and He is the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing."} 414. Say: "Shall I take as a guardian any other than Allah, the Creator of the heavens and the earth? And it is He Who feeds but is not fed." Say: "Verily, I am commanded to be the first of those who submit. "And be not you of the idolaters.} 415. Say: "I fear, if I disobey my Lord, the torment of a Mighty Day."} 416. Who is avertedfrom (such a torment) on that Day; then He (Allah) has surely been Merciful to him . And that would be the obvious success.} Allah is the Creator and the Sustainer Allah states that He is the King and Owner of the heavens and earth and all of what is in them, and that He has written mercy on His Most Honorable Self. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, c#r«aP (3.J* oXfr ZfiS tLJS jL>- UU 2)1 Ol1 «When Allah created the creation, He wrote in a Book that He has with Him above the Throne; 'My mercy overcomes My anger. I 1 ' Fath Al-Bari 13 :395, Muslim 4 :2107.

Allah said; 4t-£ vw V 4% <j} ilndeed He will gather you together on the Day of Resurrection, about which there is no doubt.} swearing by His Most Honored Self that He will gather His servants, {} iFor appointed meeting ofa known Day.} [56:50],

the Day of Resurrection that will certainly occur, and there is

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no doubt for His believing servants in this fact. As for those who deny and refuse, they are in confusion and disarray. Allah's statement, iThose who destroy themselves} on the Day of Resurrection, iwill not believe.} in the Return and thus do not fear the repercussions of that Day. Allah said next, iAnd to Him belongs whatsoever exists in the night and the day.} meaning, all creatures in the heavens and earth are Allah's servants and creatures, and they are all under His authority, powerand will; there is no

deityworthy of worship except Him, yb\ iand He is the All-Hearing, the All-Knowing.} He hears the statements of His servants and knows their actions, secrets and what they conceal. Allah then said to His servant and Messenger Muhammad jg, whom He sent with the pure Tawhid. and the straight religion, commanding him to call the people to Allah's straight path; iSay: ",Shall I take as a guardian any other than Allah, the Creator of the heavens and the earth?"}

Similarly, Allah said, 4:~pM' \$& M ji> iSay: "Do you order me to worship other than Allah, O you fools?") [39:64], The meaning here is, I will not take a guardian except Allah, without partners, for He is the Creator of the heavens and earth Who originated them without precedent, vj& %) iAnd it is He Who feeds but is not fed.) For He sustains His creatures without needing them. Allah also said; Styj Si' 'Sib iAnd I created not the firm and humans except that they should worship Me (Alone.) [51:56] Some scholars read it, rkvM# "And it is He Who feeds but He does not eat." meaning, Allah does not eat. Abu Hurayrah narrated, "A man from Al-Ansar from the area of Quba' invited the Prophet jg to eat some food, and we went along with the Prophet jg. When the Prophet jg ate and washed his hands, he said, ULL-j « Ljb L i j ^JU {j* UL~Sj " / < 0 * " • ^jjl ?" nip Vj ijjy&A 'jj filid Vj k 4^yj l^ i I JLJ ! uiLs.^ j <b Xkj><Jl 4 "A// praise is due to Allah, Who feeds but is never fed, He bestowed bounty unto us. Who gave us guidance and fed us, gave us something to drink, covered our nakedness; and for every favor He has given us. All praise is due to Allah, praise that should not be neglected, my Lord, all the while affirming that we will never be able to duly thank Him; nor be appreciative enough of Him, nor be free of needing Him.

asssiss '*• ust &r>: @Bp ^All thanks and praises J» J~**j 1* JjSjiiij] Jr ',\'' ?i"fi-> :'' ' >' ' ' • >'*,\,-\}\'Z >'• jpLi<>>)dUU^«) UX>Ui»j& p^ are due to Allah Who fed us the food, gave us the drink, covered our nudity, guided us from mis-guidance, gave us sight from blindness, and honored us above many of His creatures. All praise is due to Allah, Lord of all that exists."a 1 * 1 jjt if &£ xi[j»^ 4ld? iSay "Verily, I am commanded to be the first of those who submit themselves to Allah as (Muslims)."} from this Ummah, t\$M?^ U <> 4; 5i jsa 4 \$ /? C*lj 4And be not you of the idolaters. Say: "I fear, if I disobey my Lord, the torment of a Mighty Day."} [6:14-15],

the Day of Resurrection, t,o <v4-*^/-M 4Who is averted from} such a torment, ion that Day, He has surely been Merciful to him} meaning, Allah will have been merciful to him, iitp £K An-NasSl in Al-Kubra 6 :82

iAnd that would be the obvious success .} Allah also said, iAnd whoever is moved away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful.} [3:185], r&i 'i /»5' j' \£ 117. And if Allah touches you with harm, none can remove it but He, and if He touches you with good, then He is able to do all things.} 118. And He is the Irresistible, above His servants, and He is the All-Wise, Well-Acquainted with all things.} 119. Say: "What thing is the most great in witness?" Say: "Allah is Witness between you and I; this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach. Can you verily bear witness that besides Allah there are other gods?" Say "I bear no (such) witness!" Say : "Only He is God, alone, and truly I am innocent of what you join in worship with Him."} 420. Those to whom We have given the Scripture recognize him, as they recognize their own children. Those who have lost (destroyed) themselves will not believe.} 421. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt? Verily, the wrongdoers shall never be

successful.} Allah is the Irresistible, Able to Bring Benefit and Protect from Harm Allah states that He Alone brings benefit or harm, and that He does what He wills with His creatures, none can resist His

324 Tahir Ibn Kathir judgment or prevent what He decrees, fir" J#* J* "ji iS(>iLT— iAnd if Allah touches you with harm, none can remove it but He, and if He touches you with good, then He is able to do all things.} Similarly, Allah said, i'..z k % *Ji 'if £ u ^Whatever mercy, Allah may graht to mankind, none can withhold it, and whatever He may withhold,morn can grant it thereafter {35:2}. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah used to supplicate*; c (AtJi ill- 1>Ji u U!^ 'ij UJ V JL«Sii» «0 Allah, there is none Who can avert what You grant or give what You deprive, and no fortune ever helps the fortunate against You.®' This is why Allah said, / l / •' s /ff />^ iAnd He is the Irresistible, above His servants,} meanirig, to Him the necks are subservient, the tyrants humble before Him and He has complete control over all things. The creatures have all bowed to Allah and are humbled before His grace, honor, pride, greatness, highness and ability over all things. The creatures are insignificant before Him, for they are all under His irresistible decision and power, iand He is die All-Wise,} in all His actions, iWell-Acquainted with all things.} Who places eveiything in its m FathAl-Bari2 :379

325 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (17-21) (Part-7) rightful place, grants and favors whomever deserves His favor. Allah said next, ~ M -v iSay: 'What thing is the most great in witness?'} or what is the greatest witness, v& fr 4Say : "Allah (the Most Great!) is Witness between you and I"} for He knows what I brought you and what you will answer me with, 0*j !2» J^j} 4this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} Therefore, this Qur'an <is a warmer for alj those who hear of it. In another Ayah, Allah said, ijMry <3i J^i 4But those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.} [11:17] Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said, "Those who follow the Messenger of Allah ought to call to what the Messenger of Allah called to and warn against what he warned against." Allah said next, \$1\$} 4"Can you verity bear witness..." O idolaters, 4"that besides Allah.there are other gods?" Say, "I bear no (such) witness!"} • Similarly, in another Ayah, Allah said; ' 4J£Z IjiLjS \$} 4Thert if they testify, testifyhot you with them.} [6:150] Allah said next, ft 4Say: "Only He is God, alone, and truly I am innocent of what you join in worship with Him."}

422 . And on the Day when We shall gather them all together, We shall say to those who joined partners in worship (with Us) : "Where are your partners (false deities) whom you used to assert (as partners in worship with Allah)?"} 423 . There will then be (left) no Fitnah for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others (in worship with Allah)."} 424 . Look! How they lie against themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappearfrom them.} 425 . And of them there are some who listen to you; but We have set veils on their hearts, so they understand it not, and deafness in their ears; if they see every one of the Ayat they will not believe therein; to the point that when they come to you to argue with you, those who disbelieve say: "These are nothing but tales of the men ofold."} . And they prevent others from him and they themselves keep away from him, and (by doing so) they destroy none but themselves, yet they perceive (it) not.} The Polythiests Shall be Questioned About the Shirk They Committed About the polytheists, Allah said: iAnd on the Day when We shall gather them all together,} This is on the Day of Resurrection, when He will ask them about the idols and rivals that they worshipped instead of Him. Allah will say to them, iWhere are your partners (false deities) whom you used to assert (as partners in worship with Allah)?} Allah said in Surat Al-Qasas, &

is 4And (remember) the Day when He will call to them, and say, "Where are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?"} [28 :62].

Allah's statement. iThere will then be (left) no Fitnah for them} means, argument. 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said that, & i iThere will then be (left) no Fitnah for them in the face of the affliction that will be placed on them, 4c£SZ it \$ ijli oi ibut to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others (in worship with Allah) Allah said next, >: ,« >•* \" * f.t iLook! How they lie against themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappearfrom them.} which is similar to His other statement, jjAji j) J; & ijLJ. *yii oji ft Si f} &U. '4% \b j2 oe }Then it will be said to them : "Where are (all) those whom you used to join in worship as partners. Besides Allah?" They will say, "They have vanished from us: Nay, we did not invoke (worship) anything before." Thus Allgh leads astray the disbelievers.} (40:73-74] The Miserable Do Not Benefit from the Qur'an Allah's statement, !£< ip o+“; J cjiJ J <&>} iAnd of them there are some wlv listen to you ; but We have set veils on their hearts, so they understand it not, and deafness in their ears; if they see every one of the Aydt they will not believe therein;} (i) At-Tabari 1 1 :299

means, they come to you, (O Muhammad jg), so that they hear you recite the Qur'an, but its recitation does not benefit them, because Allah has set veils on their hearts, and so they do not understand the Qur'an, il j PE& iand (set) deafness in their ears;) that prevents them from hearing what benefits them. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ Cc (jbM=» cyj' 4A«(f the example of those who disbelieve, is as that ofhim who shouts at one who hears nothing but calls and cries.) [2:171] Allah said next, SZ4) iif they see every one of the Ayat they will not believe therein;) meaning, they will not believe in any of the Ayat, proofs, clear evidences and signs they witness because they do not have sound comprehension or fair judgment. In another Ayah, Allah said, iif£&) iHad Allah known ofany good in them, He would indeed have made them listen.) [8:23] Allah said, 4v*»- fy&) ito the point that when they come to you to argue with you...) using falsehood against truth, ithose who disbelieve say : "These are nothing but tales of the men ofold") The disbelievers say, what you (O Muhammad jg) brought us was taken from the books of those who were before us, meaning plagiarized, jl*" >** X"4-

330 Tatsir Ibn Kathir 4And they prevent othersfrom him and they themselves keep away from him,} They discourage people from following the truth, believing in Muhammad and obeying the Qur'an, 4&&£ iand they themselves keep awayfrom him,} They thus combine both evil acts, for they neither benefit themselves, nor let others benefit from the Prophet 3gl. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, 4And they prevent othersfrom him.} means, they hinder people from believing in Muhammad jg. Muhammad bin Al-Hanafiyyah said, "The disbelievers of Quraysh used to refrain from meeting Muhammad -gj and they discouraged people from coming to him."12* Similar was reported from Qatadah, Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak and several others.*3 4X%Gpi%&£\$} iand (by doing so) they destroy not but themselves, yet they perceive (it) not.} At-Tabari 11 :311. 121 At-Tabari 1 1 :31 1 [3 > At-Tabari 11 :312. J \r\ %ostsm piAyI >i> ijliIS<Cjo (* > :Ar- '.sc >> ^"(*4^ ^dr' J—'J 0 iuifi

They destroy themselves by committing this evil action, and its harm will only touch them. Yet, they do not perceive this fact! J* \$\$\$&\$ ^ Yj iji ui. ijllii je \yt) H Itj jij} jt oi tfis& # a lira& is J? * ^ \$ £ ij*i> H 5y \$> j ch 4^5^^ u, (>/* 5 i>' 427. Ifyou could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Aydt ofour

Lord, and we would be of the believers!"} 428. Nay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.} 429. And they said: "There is no (other life) but our (present) life of this world, and never shall we be resurrected."} 430. If you could but see when they will stand before their Lord! He will say: "Is not this the truth?" They will say: "Yes, by our Lord!" He will then say: "So taste you the torment because you used not to believe."} Wishes and Hopes Do Not Help One When He Sees the Torment Allah mentions the condition of the disbelievers when they are made to stand before the Fire on the Day of Resurrection and witness its chains and restraints, along with seeing the horrible, momentous conditions in the Fire with their own eyes. This is when the disbelievers will say, * sps% i"Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!"} They wish that they would be sent back to the life of the world so that they could perform righteous deeds, refrain from disbelieving in the Ayat of their Lord and be among the

332 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir believers. Allah said, <fc * tfk ca «i: j.> iNay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them.} meaning, the disbelief, denial and rebellion that they used to hide in their hearts will then be uncovered, even though they will try to hide this fact in this life and the Hereafter. Earlier, Allah said, ifm ije ot% J3 j %} 4There will then be (left) no trial for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah." Look! How they lie against themselves! But the (lie) which they invented will disappear from them.} It is also possible that the meaning here is that the disbelievers will realize the truth that they knew all along in their hearts, that is, that what the Messengers brought them in this life is true, although they used to deny his Message before their followers. Allah said that Mdsa said to Fir'awn, i';& Jftfj V]\$£\$ C3X&} i"Verily, you know that these signs have clearly been sent down by none but the Lord of the heavens and the earth as eye- opening evidence."} |17:102] Allah said about Fir'awn and his people, tils \jjZStj} iAnd they belied them (those Aydt) wrongfully and arrogantly, though they were themselves convinced thereof.} (27:14] to lyf Vi j;^ 4Nay, it has become manifest to them wltat they had been concealing before.} [6:28] When this occurs, and the disbelievers ask to be returned to this life, they will not do so because they truly wish to embrace the faith. Rather, they ask to be returned to this life for fear of the torment that they are witnessing before them,

as punishment for the disbelief they committed, and to try and avoid the Fire that they see before their eyes. £QW3& to iBut if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.} meaning, they lie when they say they wish to go back to this life so that they can embrace the faith. Allah states that even if they were sent back to the life of this world, they will again commit the disbelief and defiance that they were prohibited. 4And indeed they are liars.} in their statement that, Cj UJaf GiG- ^ ^ j)£j ftfoJ>j£i Q by 4"Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, what they had been concealing before has become manifest to them. But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars. And they said: "There is no (other life) but our (present) life of this world, and never shall we be resurrected."} Therefore, they will revert to their old behavior and say, i to iThere is no life but our life of this world} and there is no Hereafter, & to 4and never shall we be resurrected.} Allah said, 4rtj H ?sj to 4If you could but see when

they will stand before their Lord!} in front of Him, 4"Is not this the truth?"} meaning, is not Resurrection true,

>v skin, awful odor, wearing dirty clothes, who will enter his grave with him. When the unjust person sees him, he will say, 'How ugly is your face!' He will reply, 'So was your work, it was ugly.' The unjust person will say, *How foul is the odor coming from you!' He will reply, 'Such was the case with your work, it stunk.' The unjust person will say, 'How dirty are your clothes!' He will reply, 'And your work too was dirty.' The unjust person will ask, 'Who are you?' He will reply, 'I am your deeds.' So he will remain with the unjust person in his grave, and when he is resurrected on the Day of Resurrection, his companion will say to him, In the life of the world, I used to carry you because you followed desire and lust. Today, you carry me.' So he will ride on the unjust person's back and lead him until he enters the Fire. So Allah said, assm \rt % Cy0djjuoJ J&j ip#0 CsJS\$ SeS •r •> ^ "•f - Sy'S"' f>5. *y». Vfes»y->Vi^ jU \ {while they will bear their burdens on their backs; and evil indeed are the burdens that they will bearly [6:31 1"* 11 Allah's statement, At-Tabari 1 1 :328

336 Tafsir Ibt Kathir)And the life of this world is nothing but play and amusement.) means, most of it is play and amusement, iBut far better is the abode of the Hereafter for those who have Taqwd. Will you not then understand?) u t&t gss v \$ sjj>; 4' ft '4 Z) 4 vi*- 1* '&• ijj 'iU* ,>i -dlV JiJj ji' p 4 « »J lii iCi j} j illL »lU' ^ Ct jl Jfjti tj Ui oJJji— *^CTto «if4A <ft\$ Sj £ M f 433. We know indeed the griefwhich their words cause you; it is not you that they deny, but it is the verses ofAllah that the wrongdoers deny.) 434. Verily, (many) Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt, till Our help reached them, and none can alter the Words of Allah. Surely, there has reached you the information about the Messengers (before you).) 435. If their aversion is hard on you, tlten if you were able to seek a tunnel in the ground or a ladder to the sky, so that you may bring them a sign. And had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together upon true guidance, so be not you one of the ignorant.) 436. It is only those wlv listen, that will respond, but as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.) Comforting the Prophet^ Allah comforts the Prophet jg in his grief over his people's denial and defiance of him,

337Surah 6. Al-An'dm (33 - 36) (Part-7) }We know indeed the griefwhich their words cause you ;} meaning. We know about their denial of you and your sadness and sorrow for them. Allah said in other Ayat, jiui ZlZ \$>} iSo destroy not yourself in sorrow for them (35:8], and ilt may be that you are going to kill yourself with grief, that they do not become believers.} [26:3], and. fife iPerhaps, you, would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps (for their turning away from you), because they believe not in this narration.} (18:6] Allah's statement, tit is not you that they deny, but it is the verses of Allah that the wrongdoers deny.} means, they do not accuse you of being a liar, v&j. 'JQ'j} ibut it is the Verses ofAllah that the wrongdoers deny.} It is only the truth that they reject and refuse. Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned that Az-Zuhri said that Abu Jahl, Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb and Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq once came to listen to the Prophet reciting the Qur'an at night, but these three men were not aware of the presence of each other. So they listened to the Prophet's recitation until the morning, and then left. They met each other on their way back and each one of them asked the others, "What brought you?" So they mentioned to each other the reason why they came. They vowed not to repeat this incident so that the young men of Quraysh would not hear ofwhat they did and imitate them. On the second night, each

one of the three came back thinking that the other two would not come because of the vows they made to each other. In the morning, they again met each other on their way back and criticized each other, vowing not to

Hereafter is for His believing servants. Allah said in other Ayat, p pi WA 4And, verily, Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers. That they verily would be made triumphant. And that Our hosts, they verily would be the victors.» (37:171-173], and, * - iAllah has decreed: "Verily! It is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, Almighty (58:21] Allah said; iSurely, there has reached you the information about the Messengers (before you).\$ who were given victory and prevailed over the people who rejected them. And you (O Muhammad jg), have a good example in them. Allah said next, 4If their aversion is hard on you ,^ and you cannot be patient because of their aversion, lIU' 3 Lii jl 3, hi jp? ^ 1 4then if you were able to seek a tunnel in the ground or a ladder to the sky.. .\$ 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "If you were able to seek a tunnel and bring them an Ayah, or go up a ladder in the sky and bring a better Ayah than the one I (Allah) gave them, then do that."111 Similar was reported from Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.*21 Allah's statement, At-Tabari 11 :338. (2> At-Tabari 11 :338.

340 To, iAnd had Allah willed. He could have gathered them together upon true guidance, so be not you one of the ignorant is similar to His statement, (•4^==’ ufjVf 4 t*Cj 5S }And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all ofthem together 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4And had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together upon true guidance,} "The Messenger of Allah ^ was eager that all people believe and be guided to follow him. Allah told him that only those whose happiness Allah has written in the first Dhikr will believe. |11 Allah's statement. 4It is only those who listen, that will respond,} means, only those who hear the speech, comprehend and understand it, will accept your call, O Muhammad 3g! In another Ayah, Allah said; jc JjiK Ui. jjiT Jt jju1 ^ iThat it may give warning to him who is living, and that the Word may be justified against the disbelievers.} [36:70], Allah's statement, i*£2. ih fSgz ibut as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.} refers to the disbelievers because their hearts are dead. Therefore, Allah resembled them to dead corpses as a way of mocking and belittling them, saying, M f W frv. ^ At-Taban 1 1 :340 . Meaning those He had decreed to believe

ibut as for the dead (disbelievers), Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned (for their recompense.) &'j h:% J# j»b s3 Xi 5 « -/•#£^ 4 ui^j u ^ JjL y£l» Vj JfjK 4 Jt i*j Vdiii 4 ^2; ti usas, i;lr si*; is a ^& 4"ni ^ V- , "u iui 1*5 ** rJ j'f 437. And they said: "Why is not a sign sent down to himfrom his lord?" Say : "Allah is certainly able to send down a sign, but most of them know not.") <33. There is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its txoo wings, but are Umam like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered . 439. Those who reject Our Aydt are deaf and dumb in darkness. Allah sends astray whom He wills and He guides on the straight path whom He wills.) The Idolaters Ask for a Miracle Allah states that the idolaters used to proclaim, "Why does not (Muhammad) bring an Ayah from his Lord," meaning, a miracle of their choice! They would sometimes say, &• 4"We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forthfrom the groundfor us.") [17:90). 43Xi * % Jg J# J,s& •iv 4Say ",Allah is certainly able to send down a sign, but most of them know not.") Certainly, Allah is able to send an Ayah (sign). But, He

decided out of His wisdom to delay that, because if He sends an Ayah of their liking and they still do not believe, this will hasten their punishment as with the previous nations. Allah said in other Aydt, ijiki SiCW ifo L41»j l,; <v**~=* J V) £j)

iAnd nothing stops Us from sending the Aydt but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to warn, and to make them afraid (of destruction).} (17:59), and, ilfWe will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility (26:4). The Meaning ofUmam Allah said, iThere is not a moving (living) creature on earth, nor a bird thatflies with its two wings, but are Umam like you.} Mujahid commented, “Meaning, various species that have distinct names.”¹¹¹ Qatadah said, “Birds are an Ummah, humans are an Ummah and the Jinns are an Ummah.”¹¹² As-Suddi said that, ipti fA%} ibut are Umam like you.} means, creations (or species).¹³¹ Allah’s statement, iWe have neglected nothing in the Book,} means, the knowledge about all things is with Allah, and He never forgets any of His creatures, nor their sustenance, nor their affairs, whether these creatures live in the sea or on land. In another Ayah, Allah said; At-Tabari 11:345. At-Tabari 11:345. At-Tabari 11:345.

}And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit (in the uterus, grave, etc.). All is in a Clear Book.} [11:61, there is a record of their names, numbers, movements, and lack of movement. In another Ayah, Allah said; oAj fey& fe-y J-i*- ^ #’> cC iAnd so many a moving creature there is, that carries not its own provision! Allah provides for it andfar you . And He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} [29:60] Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said about the Ayah, ithen unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered.} “Death gathers them.” It was also said that the Day of Resurrection gathers them, for in another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd when the wild beasts shall be gathered together.} [81:5] ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said about Allah’s statement, i<Z3/A ft) (3) £ at 4 ^ ft ibut are Umam like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered.} “All creatures will be gathered on the Day of Resurrection, the beasts, birds and all others. Allah’s justice will be so perfect, that the un-homed sheep will receive retribution from the homed sheep. Allah will then command them, *Be dust!’ This is when the disbeliever will say, 4®&& i”Woe to me! Would that 1 were dwsf/V[78:40]. And this was reported from the Prophet j|5 in the Hadith about the Trumpet. I1 ! Ibn Abi Hatim 4 : 1286. 121 At-Tabari 11:347.

344 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Disbelievers will be Deafand Mute in Darkness Allah said, 4Those who reject Our Ayat are deafand dumb in darkness.} due to their ignorance, little knowledge and minute comprehension. Their example is that of the deaf-mute who cannot hear nor speak, as well as being blinded by darkness. Therefore, how can such a person find guidance to the path or change the condition he is in? Allah said in other Ayat, 4 \$35 a a’i fe C iitSl iTheir parable is that ofone who kindled a fire; then, when it illuminated all around him, Allah took away their light and left them in darkness. (So) they could not see. They are deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path)} [2:17- 18], and, I’t *’ t* I? A* •’ ^ i\ V”! o—Ji» ^ jy -A-Jy y. gy y* ^ C.:.l.bS ot A »-* b_y au’ 2 iij jaMi iOr like the darkness in a vast deep sea, overwhelmed with a great wave topped by a great wave, topped by dark clouds, darkness, one above anotlter, ifa man stretches out his hand, he can hardly see it! And

he for whom Allah has not appointed light, far him there is no light.} [24:40] This is why Allah said here, iAllah sends astray whom He wills and He guides on the straight path whom He wills.} for He does what He wills with His creatures. 0^ Sy-X yS itlll j>l ji\ 4Am. (&} 'ijyOfafS U jj-jjj »Ii jl JjtX £ I t.fac* ofax J» (jyoixCi iL-t ,v»iW. jtlfcu JpxX Soj jj jJi tixji c& £ i&tt *\$ sgj & j3; \%

345Surah 6. Al-An'dm (40 - 45) (Part-7) 5*" ?• (4 j^ CIj W :»:'o£2 £ % S£ c/J' ffS\ Jta £^4i ^ A iif; iJub «^s£ir 440. Say; "Te/i me if Allah's torment comes upon you, or the Hour comes upon you, would you then call upon any one other than Allah? (Reply) if you are truthful!" } 441 . Nay! To Him alone you call, and, if He willed, He would remove that (distress) for which you call upon Hun, and you forget at that time whatever partners you joined with Him (in worship)! } 442. Verily, We sent (Messengers) to many nations before you. And We seized them with extreme poverty and loss ofhealth so that they might believe with humility.} 443. When Our torment reached them, why then did they not believe with humility? But their hearts became hardened, and Shaytdn made fair-seeming to them that which they used to do.} 444. So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened to them the gates of every (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all ofa sudden, We took them to punishment, and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.}

347Surah 6. Al-An'am (40 - 45) tPart-7) That is, loss ofwealth and diminished provisions, 4atid loss ofhealth} various illnesses, diseases and pain, &} iso that they might believe with humility and call Allah and supplicate to Him with humbleness andhumility. Allah said; iljCZ SJ. Vj5^ iWhen Our torment reached them, why then did they not believe with humility?} Meaning: Why do they not believe and humble themselves before Us when We test them with disaster?' iBut their hearts became hardened,} for their hearts are not soft orhumble, iand Shaytan made fair-seeming to them that which they used to do.} J That is. Shirk, defiance and rebellion. iSo, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded,} by ignoring and turning away from it, i,^ GZ } iWe opened to them the gates ofeverything,} Meaning: We opened the gates of provisions for them fromwherever they wished, so that We deceive them.' We seekrefuge with Allah from such an end. This is why Allah said, lit iuntil in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given,} such as wealth, children and provisions.

ijj) p&Q} iall of a sudden, We took them to punishment and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.} They have no hope for any type of good thing. Al-Hasan Al- Basri said, "Whoever Allah gives provision and he thinks that Allah is not testing him, has no wisdom. Whoever has little provision and thinks that Allah will not look at (provide for) him, has no wisdom." He then recited the Ayah, rjji Cf*- U 'j—i U-Uy <{So, w/jen they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened to them the. gates 0/ ei>ery (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden, We took them to punishment, and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.} He added, "By the Lord of the Ka'baM Allah deceived these people, when He gave them what they wished, and then they were punished." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement.11 ' k fcs&£ 42 pz 52 4 %<} \$} ^ 42K 2\$ ^ * ps& 4%'^. 446. Say: "Tell me, ifAllah took away your hearing and your sight, and sealed up your hearts, is there a god oihet than Allah who could restore them to you?" See how variously We -• explain the Aydt, yet they turn

aside.} 447. Say: "Tell me, if the punishment of Allah comes to you suddenly, or openly, will any be destroyed except the wrongdoing people?"} m Ad-DurrAl-ManthUr 3 :270 , Ibn Abi Hatim 4 :129 1

349Surah 6^ Al-An'dm (46 - 49) (Part-7) •^48. And We send not the Messengers but as givers of glad tidings and as wamers . So whosoever believes and does righteous good deeds, upon such shall dome no fear, nor shall , grieve.} ... 449. But those who reject Our Ayat, the torment will strike themfor their rebelling.} Allah said to His Messenger, say,,O Muhammad to those rebellious liars, v iTell me, ifAllah took away your hearing and your sight.} rA 'ju»t as He gave these senses to*you. In another Ayah, Allah said; ^ m 4' 1} 4It is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing, seeing.} [67:23]. The Ayah above might also mean that Allah will not allow the disbelievers to benefit from these senses in religious terms. This is why He said next, 4and sealed up your hearts, .} He also said in other Ayat, \$} 40r who owns hearing and sight?} [10:31], and, ^ J/z at \pjdj} 4And know that Allah comes in between a person and his heart.} Allah said; ik ifr 4/s there a god other than Allah who could restore them to you?} Meaning, is there anyone except Allah who is able to give you back these senses if Allah took them from you? Only Allah is able to do so, and this is why He said here,

351Surah 6. Al-An'am (50 - 54) (Part-7 iSo whosoever believes and does righteous good deeds. meaning, whoever believes in his heart with what the Messengers were sent with and makes his works righteous by imitating them; iupon such shall come no fear,\$ concerning the future, inor shall they grieve. about what they missed in the past and left behind them in this world. Certainly, Allah will be the Wall and Protector over what they left behind. Allah said next, Jii Ij»L>. (gj ./ ,s c ^ ^ -. 's.' : , *1 '- *N_ j_pJajaJ ^4j {£JJ>g;Qijl s^i j\$£ ££* 6&G. \$T iBut those who reject Our Ayat, the torment will strike them for their rebelling The torment will strike them because of disbelieving in the Message of the Messengers, defying Allah's commands, committing what He prohibited and transgressing His set limits. *1\$ Si 4iP Jit t? fiS%\$ & Jit V j J '&k Sj * jit; ig&fcsS *1^ >iVf u£S js jj& £& - "l) CjP\$£ii (iitil gji* Vj clj o; ^*1 J^t \2-i-4 <, • * X\Sx' . * s+* < A A ,/»•* .i-rflf f (>5 Uj ^ (v-£w->>r ^ ^Xm> U ojA^ - *4p Ojf'-k

352 Tafstr Ibn Kathir uj?«r! Oi £>JSi jj ojUji iiiiC. IjjJ i^tlj ill Jjt iLju ^ j, il(oi '*>"• (^J J~i >>• /j HJff ^__iJ J* pCjJ pS2f. jlil Jii CiJ*> y^c., » '.,»>'. >ck ".•'{' '• t s .' . ss *^.,-*5»-j j#4* a>“ nf»»y o* v»l* >- • />)+£ 450. Say: "/ don't tell you that with me are the treasures of Allah, nor (that) I know the Unseen; nor do I tell you that I am an angel. / but follow what is revealed to me.” Say: "Are die blind and the one who sees equal? Will you not then consider?'y 451. And warn therewith those wlv fear that they will be gathered before their Lord, when there will be neither a protector nor an intercessor for them besides Him, so that they may have Taqwa 452. And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and evening seeking His Face. You are accountable for them in nothing, and they are accountable for you in nothing, that you may turn them away, and thus become of the wrongdoersy 453. Thus We have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from amongst us?" Does not Allah know best those wlv are grateful?} 454. When those wlv believe in Our Ayat come to you, say: "Saldmun 'Alaykum” (peace be on you); your Lord has written mercyfor Himself, so that, ifany ofyou does evil in ignorance, and thereafter repents and does righteous good deeds, then surely, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Mercifully TheMessengerNeitherhastheKeytoAllah'sTreasures, NorKnows the Unseen Allah said to His Messenger

4^' os*>- 4^5 Jy'V J*) 4Say: "I don't tell you that with me are the treasures of Allah "> meaning, I do not own Allah's treasures or have any power over them,

jSa%} 4«or (that) I know the Unseen,} and I do not say that I know the Unseen, because its knowledge is with Allah and 1 only know what He conveys of it to me. inor I tell you that I am an angel.} meaning, I do not claim that 1 am an angel. I am only a human to whom Allah sends revelation, and He honored me with this duty and favored me with it. ih Irk £ dj\$& 41 but follow what is revealed to me.} and I never disobey the revelation in the least. jfZ JS \$} iSay: "Are the blind and the one who sees equal?"} meaning, Is the one who is guided, following the truth, equal to the one misled?' ilf&l <&} iWill you not then consider?} In another Ayah, Allah said; 4\$*4Vi ijji iShall he then who knows that ivhal has been revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men of understanding that pay heed.} (13:19] Allah's statement, Vj elf S4 di J oyC* ukf *> j dj} iAnd warn therewith those who fear that they will be gathered before their Lord, when there will be neither a protector nor an intercessor for them besides Him,} means, warn with this Qur'an, O Muhammad jg, C1L 'jt pX jk\} \$Those who live in awe for fear of their Lord} [23:57], who,

354 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir *4{j ^ iFear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} [13:21], JI ^ o>&} 4those who fear that they will be gathered before their Lord,} on the Day of Resurrection, iwhen there will be neither a protector nor an intercessor for them besides Him,} for on that Day, they will have no relative or intercessor who can prevent His torment if He decides to punish them with it, 4so that they may have Taqwa.} Therefore, warn of the Day when there will be no judge except Allah, iso that they may have Taqwa.} and thus work good deeds in this life, so that their good deeds may save them on the Day of Resurrection from Allah's torment, and so that He will grant them multiple rewards. Prohibiting the Messenger from Turning the Weak Away and the Order to Honor Them 4 Allah said, f £2> ^j} 4And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and evening seeking His Face.} meaning, do not turn away those who have these qualities, instead make them your companions and associates. In another Ayah, Allah said;

355 Surah 6. Al-An'am (50 - 54) (Part-7) \$And keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and evening, seeking His Face, and let not your eyes overlook them, desiring the pomp and glitter of the life of the world; and obey not him whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance, one who follows his own lusts and whose affair (deeds) has been /osf.>[18:28] Allah's statement, iinvoke their Lord...} refers to those who worship Him and supplicate to Him, imorning and evening.} referring to the obligatory prayers, according to Said bin Al-Musayyib, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Qatadah. In another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd your Lord said, "Invoke Me, I will respond (to your invocation)."} [40:60], I will accept your supplication. Allah said next, <fc« 4seeking His Face.} meaning, they seek Allah's Most Generous Face, by sincerity for Him in the acts of worship and obedience they perform. Allah said; iYou are accountable for them in nothing, and they are accountable for you in nothing,} This is similar to the answer Nflh gave to his people when they said, 4S&V?& Si >\$} iSltall we believe in you, when the meekest (of the people) fallow you?"} [26:111]. NOh answered them, 'jir*-* j) ^r' -5- <1>1 Uj U>>

"\ 'S l_4r"" t* (&& iHad it been a good thing, they (weak and poor) would not have preceded us to it!} [46:11], and, H&1 iV& Jtt I & ^i>} iAnd when Our clear verses are recited to them, those who

disbelieve say to those who believe : "Which of the two groups is best in position and station."} [19:73] Allah said in reply, 4 ^ (U jj & (4£* S3iS -\$>} }And how many a generation (past nations) have We destroyed before them, who were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} [19:74]. Here, Allah answered the disbelievers when they said, J# Lry "if 4“Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from amongst us?" Does not Allah know best those who are grateful?} Meaning is not Allah more knowledgeable of those who thank and appreciate Him in statement, action and heart? Thus Allah directs these believers to the ways of peace, transfers them from darkness to light by His leave, and guides them to the straight path. In another Ayah, Allah said; 4As for those who strive hard for Us (Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths (i.e. Allah's religion). And verily, Allah is with the doers of good"} [29:69]. An authentic Hadlth states, Ji 'M Ji% J'M n ai «Allah does not look at your shapes or colors, but He looks at your heart and actions. n 1 * 1 111 Muslim 4: 1987.

Allah's statement, jii I'Zr fy} iWhen those who believe in Our Aydt come to you, say: "Salamun 'Alaykum" (peace be on you);} means, honor them by returning the Saldm and give them the good news of Allah's exclusive, encompassing mercy for them. So Allah said; iyour Lord has written Mercyfor Himself,} meaning, He has obliged His Most Honored Self to grant mercy, as a favor, out of His compassion and beneficence, iSo that, ifany ofyou does evil in ignorance. . .} as every person who disobeys Allah does it in ignorance, iand thereafter repents and does righteous good deeds,} by repenting from the sins that he committed, intending not to repeat the sin in the future, but to perform righteous deeds, fv j** P*} ithen surely, He is Oft-Forgiving Most Merciful.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger ofAllah said, j) • iij* •J"* y* oi 'r^ l>J tWhen Alldh finished with the creation, He wrote in a Book that He has with Him above the Throne, 'My mercy prevails overMy anger'. This Hadith was also recorded in the The Two ScUuhsS2 & 3 14& J Ahmad 2:313. 121 Path Al-Bari 13 :395 , Muslim 4 : 2107

^ J* '^jA- ^^ 'H -** (^=5, *| y^ g' J* >' ce o»j* Ji»jj jo j£2Jf jjLillii u .— u >i-x£=>j aj o* >4^ ,;<v 'a. ~ ..ttf . . -f .1 f, /*©*c . ,<tr 455. And thus do We explain the Ayat in detail, that the way of the criminals, may become manifest.} 456. Say: "I have been forbidden to worship those whom you invoke (worship) besides AUdh." Say: ",I will not follow your vain desires. If I did, I would go astray, and I would not be one of the rightly guided."} 457. Say: "I am on clear proof from my Lord, but you deny it. I do not have what you are hastily seeking (the torment). The decision is only for Allah, He declares the truth, and He is the best of judges."} 455. Say: "If I had that which you are asking for impatiently (the torment), the matter would have been settled at once between you and I, but Allah knows best the wrongdoers."} 459. And with Him are the keys of tite Ghayb (all that is hidden), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is on the land and in the sea; not a leaf falls, but he knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} The Prophet^ Understands What He Conveys; Torment is in Allah's Hands Not the Prophet's Allah says, just as We mentioned the clear signs that testify and direct to the path of guidance, all the while chastising useless arguments and defiance, 4*4?i J<5§> iAnd thus do We explain the Ayat in detail,} that is, whatever responsible adults need explained to them, in the affairs of life and religion,

360 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4.3%*-J ' Xk Uf£Q>) iThat the way of the criminals may become manifest.) so that the path of the criminals who defy the Prophets is apparent and clear. This Ayah was also said to

mean, so that you, O Muhammad jg, are aware of the path of the criminals. Allah's statement, 4oj ci &4 \$) 4Say: "I am on clear proof from my Lord..." means: I have a clear understanding of the Law of Allah that He has revealed to me, ibut you deny it.) meaning, but you disbelieve in the truth that came to me from Allah. 4*U '- e £) 41 do not have what you are hastily seeking) meaning, the torment, 4k^ & iThe decision is only for Allah,) for the ruling of this is with Allah. If He wills, He will punish you soon in response to your wish! If He wills, He will give you respite, out of His great wisdom. This is why Allah said, iHe declares the truth, and He is the best of judges.) and the best in reckoning between His servants. Allah's statement, 4l^=s^tj jiVt5^ 'H it 4Say : "If I had that which you are asking for impatiently (the torment), the matter would have been settled at once between you and I,") means, if I have what you ask for, I will surely send down what you deserve of it, jJU i iuij) ibut Allah knows best the wrongdoers)

Someone might ask about the meaning of this Ayah compared to the Hadith in the Two Sahihs, from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that she said to the Messenger, "O Allah's Messenger jg! Have you encountered a day harder than the day (of the battle) of Uhud?" The Prophet sg replied, t/r41 C— vi-jJ 13 xil jISj Irt lib <_£ u i.j'isxs. j, jJtJil* J,\ t^iUa ai <3l>^i uf c-iij n_JUi!l jyb Ml jjiil jUi i "dij* 3ji £-«- -li <3)1 jl : Jlii ij*^Jl <Ilp ^ifor tfj li)i o^tli • <Jli t j» C-X-* l»J i ij11>J I tllLa JjLJj ilju liilip IjJj Uj Itijj Jji jj <3)1 jj !jIA< 13 :Jli p kQZ. jjL-j JC>JI siiU Jalii oi tii ii^iL ivliiJj ^^1*3 jjj iJjJ drJ ^ J 'Ht ?&' Jj-j' «j3Ll>-Sll •iLi «, *1^ M 33)1 J^*3 'J* }r lYour people have troubled me alot and the worst trouble was on the day of 'Aqabah when I presented myself to Ibn 'Abd Ydlil bin 'Abd Kuldl, who did not respond to my call. So I departed, overwhelmed with severe sorrow, proceeded on and could not relax until I found myself at Qam Ath-Tha'dlib where I raised my head towards the sky to see a cloud unexpectedly shading me. I looked up and saw Jibril in it and he called me saying, 'Indeed Allah has heard what you said to the people and what they have responded to you. Therefore, Allah has sent the Angel of the Mountains to you so that you may order him to do whatever you wish to these people.' The Angel of the Mountains called and greeted me, and then said, 'O Muhammad! verily, Allah has heard how your people responded to you and He has sent me to you so that you could order me to do what you wish. If you like, I will let Al-Akhshabayn (two mountains to the north and south of Makkah) fall on them.' The Prophet £ said, No, but I hope that Allah will let them generate offspring who will worship Allah Alone, and will worship none besides Him.»{1} IM FathAl-B&ri 6 :360 , Muslim 3 : 1420

362 Tafoir Ibtt Kathir This is the wording of Muslim. Tormenting the disbelievers of Quraysh was offered to the Prophet jg, but he chose patience and asked Allah for respite for them, so that Allah might let them generate offspring who will not associate anything with Him in worship. Therefore, how can we combine the meaning of this Hadith and the honorable Ayah, " V ^ iSay: "If I had that which you are asking for impatiently (the torment), the matter would have been settled at once between you and I, but Allah knows best the wrongdoers The answer to this question is, Allah knows the best, that the Ayah states that if the punishment that they asked for was in the Prophet's hand at the time, he would have sent it on them as they asked. As for the Hadith, the disbelievers did not ask the Prophet to send the torment down on them. Rather, the angel responsible for the mountains offered him the choice to let the two mountains to the north and south of Makkah close in on the disbelievers and crush them. The Prophet did not wish that and asked for respite out of compassion for them. Only Allah Knows

theUnseen Allah said next, \$And with Him are the keys of the Ghayb (all that is hidden), none knows them but He.\$ Al-Bukhari recorded that Salim bin ‘Abdullah said that his father said that the Messenger of Allah said, .S.I yj v yti. iT/ie keys ofthe Unseen arefive and none except Allah knows them £2 ^13 c; 4 C jGJ -Xg, pe fe 2 i(\$\$s is&k ^A 5% C&4^ - iVerily, Allah! With Him (Alone) is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. No person knows what he will earn tomorrow, and no person knows in what land he will die. Verily, Allah is All-Knower,

363Surah 6. Al-An'dm (60 - 62) (Part-7 All-Aware}’’» [31:34].m Allah’s statement, <s&\$a c iAttd He kttows whatever there is on the land and in the sea;} means, Allah’s honored knowledge encompasses everything, including the creatures living in the sea and on land, and none of it, not even the weight of an atom on earth or in heaven, ever escapes His knowledge. Allah’s statement, Ji Cj} inot a leaffalls, but He blows it.} means, He knows the movements of everything including inanimate things. Therefore, what about His knowledge of the living creatures, especially, those whom the Divine laws have been imposed upon such as mankind and the Jinns? In another Ayah, Allah said; Cj pz} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes, and all that the breasts conceal.} [40:19] J \r« saiposssm .&) p’&j’Uit Oigx Ij\0£.^3c. yt,js • < > < •Site -is’ Jr jC^ £ jU^> ijil y«j^ k#^ 3? >u&% pr u* y &\ Ml Fath Al-Bdri8:141.

364 Tafsxr Ibn Kathir Jl \%? H&&£m P** *1£ SfiS. 460. It is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day, then he raises (wakes) you up again, that a term appointed be fulfilled, then (in the end), unto Him will be your return. Then He will inform you ofwhat you used to do.} 461. He is the Qdhir over His servants, and He sends guardians over you, until when death approaches one of you, Our messengers take his soul, and they never neglect their duty.} 462. Then they are returned to Allah, their Master, the Just Lord. Surely, His is the judgment and He is the swiftest in taking account.} The Servants are in Allah’s Hands Before and After Death Allah states that He brings death to His servants in then- sleep at night, for sleep is minor death. Allah said in other Ayat, 4And (remember) when Allah said: "O ‘Isa! I will take you and raise you to Myself..."} [3:55], and, t" ,j£ jJZ jJ ujft) ijri 4j^& dl&&S opt 4It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep. He keeps those (souls) for which He has ordained death and sends the rest for a term appointed.}[39A2\, thus mentioning both minor and major death. Allah says, 4\$\ j»j} 4It is He, Wlto takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day,}

meaning, He knows the deeds and actions that you perform during the day. This Ayah demonstrates Allah’s perfect knowledge of His creation, by day and night, and in their movements and idleness. Allah said in other Ayat, ilt is the same (to Him) whether any ofyou conceal his speech or declare it openly, whether he be hid by night or go forth freely by day.) [13:10], and ->0*5 j4* *0 otj) ilt is out of His mercy that He made night and day, so that you may rest therein), by night, iand that you may seek ofHis bounty) by day. Allah said, 'J® GZj jlf&£) iAnd (We) have made the night as a covering. And (We) have made the dayfor livelihood.) [78:10-1 1]. Allah said here, ilt is He, Who takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day,) [6:60], Then said, ithen he raises (wakes) you up again,) by day, according to Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi. Allah’s statement, IP &*l) ithat a term appointed befulfilled) refers to the life span of every person, m At-Tabari 5:212.

ithen (in the end), unto Him will be your return. on the Day of Resurrection, p Kt ft?,p iThen He will inform you of what you used to do.} He will reward you, good for good, and evil for evil. Allah's statement, s*jt 4He is the Qahir over His servants.} The Qahir means, the one who controls everything, all are subservient to His supreme grace, greatness and majesty, iand He sends guardians over you,} angels who guard mankind. In another Ayah, Allah said; .. il 4For each (person), there are angels in succession, before and behind him. They guard him by the command of Allah.} 113:11], watching his deeds and recording them. Allah said, 4But verily, over you (are appointed angels in charge of mankind) to watch you.} [82:10], and, vib V] 02 JiiL ifrf ge, if yUUJ' Jk. 4(Remember!) that the two receivers (recording angels) receive, one sitting on the right and one on the left. Not a word does he utter, but there is a watcher by him, ready.} [50:17-18]. Allah's statement, pi& »'*&} ^until when death approaches one of you...} refers to, when one's life span comes to an end and he is dying,

iOur messengers take his soul ...^ meaning, there are angels who are responsible for this job. Ibn 'Abbas and several others said that the Angel of Death has angels who pull the soul from its body and when it reaches the throat, the Angel of Death captures it.¹¹ ' Allah said; iand they never neglect their duty.)> They guard the soul of the dead person and take it to wherever Allah wills, to 'Uiyyim if he was among the righteous, and to Styth*2 * if he was among the wicked (disbelievers, sinners, etc.), we seek refuge with Allah from this end. Allah said next, iThen they are returned to Allah, their Master, the Just Lord.> Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet 2i said, Ji jls Ijji I j)> 'r'JJ ijlliJl J) Jli; JljJ 1^ ia-JiII 4'V* :JUj ?IJL» j* JUj l\$J Jly 1jL^t VJJ tk-«l*Jl «&»• a* uij > &> ifc? J» ;uui Ji 1*^ ills ijj Jiii ^^>1 1 Oj\5 AtJl ijL LJif trf^s"l - l_yJl» vluJ l\$J Jli' <Jl>" ^ ja (£rrjf} iirfi .JliJ ?lji ja :JLi l\$J ^i:— » tjLUL Jj .ijl (_ruJL L»-^* V : 1 j'iii cr^*s* ' JI ^a J^, 'ji <—<l^if till £cjj V aJ At-Jabari 11:410. Refer to Surat Al-Mutaffifin, 83 :7-9 and 8-21

iSay: "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. All will surely be gathered together for an appointed meeting of a known Day."} [56:49-50] and, jiU j}i f&Z-j^ 4And We shall gather them all together so as to leave not one of them behind...} [18:47] until, iAnd your Lord treats no one with injustice.} [18:49] Allah said here, P%P 3* &£} itheir Master, the just Lord. Surely, His is the judgement and He is the swiftest in taking account.} [6:62] Xm /(*)> jil J £ Jitft 2 5 \$? yjr jf^6 £&S i ^ ££ \$ft# « \$-& i* «3i £5 463. Say: "W/io resales you from the dark recesses of the land and the sea, when you call upon Him begging and in secret (saying) : 'IfHe (Allah) only saves us from these (dangers), we shall truly be grateful."} 464. Say: "Allah rescues you from these (dangers) and from all distress, and yet you commit Shirk."} 465. Say: "He has the power to send torment on you from above or from under your feet, or to Yalbisakum in party strife, and make you taste the violence of one another." See how variously We explain the Ayat, so that they may understand.} Allah's Compassion and Generosity, and His Power and Torment Allah mentions how He favors His servants, saving them during times of need, in the darkness of land and at sea, such as when storms strike. In such cases, they call on Allah alone, without partners, in supplication. In other Ayat, Allah said.

370 Tafsir Ibnt Kathfr ik fy) iAnd when harm strikes you at sea, those that you call upon besides Him vanish from you except Him.) [17:67], ^ £4* eVJm Vte-j ^ ^ jil ^ af ijs in jJ\$ ^\$ *gx fa iHe it is Who enables you to travel through the land and the sea, till when you are in the ships and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they rejoice, then comes a stormy wind and the waves come to them from all

sides, and they think that they are encircled therein, they invoke AIM, making their faith pure for Him alone, saying: "If You deliver us from this, we shall truly be of the grateful".) [10:22], and, if) 'ffa \$\$ & tfr Sf i ils not He (better than your gods) Wlw guides you in the darkness of the land and the sea, and Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy? Is there any god with Allah? High Exalted be AIM above all that they associate as partners (with Him!) [27:63]. Allfih said in this honorable Ayah, jffri jK if iSay : "Who rescues you from the dark recesses of the land and the sea, when you call upon Him begging and in secret." i.e., in public and secret, 4&4) 4(Saying): 'IfHe (Allah) only saves us...) from this distress, 4U&* U iwe shall truly be grateful.) thereafter. Allah said, ^ y

iSay: "Allah rescues you from these (dangers) and from all distress , and yet you commit Shirk."} meaning, yet you call other gods besides Him in times of comfort. Allah said; 4S<y; "He /ias the power to send torment on youfrom above or from under yourfeet,"} He said this after His statement, 4&P ^And yet you commit Shirk.} Allah said next, 1Z *1 jjUt y iSay: "He has the power to send torment on you.."}, after He saves you. Allah said in Surah Subhan (chapter 17), p <sr fy i&z ot s# 43® p 0& \$ j(U fui Vl oyi y 4 ^ •£j iu4 ^ y jji' viC 3 i ,s£i>y^ O* yt 2r* J ^ . iYour Lord is He Wlw drives the ship for you through the sea, in order that you may seek of His bounty. Truly! He is Ever Merciful towards you. And when harm strikes you upon the sea, those that you call upon besides Him vanish from you except Him. But when He brings you safely to land, you turn away (from Him). And man is ever ungrateful. Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up, or that He will not send against you a storm ofstones? Then, you shall find no guardian. Or do you feel secure that He will not send you back a second time to sea, and send against you a hurricane ofwind and drown you because ofyour disbelief, then you will not find any avenger therein against Us?} (17:66-69). Al-Bukhari, may Allah grant him His mercy, commented on Allah's statement,

372 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 'frXr}^ Ji j' J 6i&& j£3* J\$ Ji&' > «®i£4SS p® *#f4^ oT j&£ jk %z iSay : "He has the power to send torment on youfrom above or from under your feet, or to Yalbisakum in party strife, and make you taste the violence ofone another." See haw variously We explain the Ayat, so that they may understand.) "Yalbisakum means, 'cover you with confusion', So it means to, 'divide into parties and sects'. Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, 'When this Ayah was revealed, 40 Jjfif 2 \$) 4Say: "He has power to send torment on youfrom above") Allah's Messenger jg said, «/ seek refuge with Your Face .» 4'0\$ at Aprfrom under yourfeet,) he^ again said, ijf,i «/ seek refuge with Your Face .» 4c5"! aX fk*. AjiJ 0).& 4or to cover you with confusion in party strife, and make you to taste the violence ofone another.) he jg said, jt — jy>l ;JU> uThis is less burdensome or easiery "]1) Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith again in the book of Tawhid (in his Sahih)W and An-Nasat also recorded it in the book of TqfsirP' m Fath Al-Bari 8:141. 121 Fath Al-Bari 13 :400 ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :340.

Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas said, We accompanied the Messenger of Allah jg and passed by the Masjid ofBani Mu'awiyah. The Prophet ig went in and offered a two Rak'ah prayer, and we prayed behind him. He supplicated to his Lord for a long time and then said, «J asked my Lord Jbr three: I asked Him not to destroy my Ummah (Muslims) by drowning and He gave that to me. I asked Him not to destroy my Ummah by famine and He gave that to me. And I asked Him not to make them taste the violence ofone another, but He did not give that to me . Muslim, but not Al-Bukhari, recorded this Hadith in the book on Fitana (trials) (of his SahthJ. Another Hadith Imam Ahmad

and the Hereafter. Those who defy me will become miserable in this life and the Hereafter. So Allah said; 4f°r every news there is a reality...} meaning, for every news, there is a reality, in that, this news will occur, perhaps after a while, according to Ibn ‘Abbas and others. Allah said in other Ayat, AAnd you shall certainly know the truth of it after a while } [38:88] and, fipy 4(For) each and every matter there is a decree (from Allah).} [13:38], This, indeed, is a warning and a promise that will surely occur, 4oilli 4and you will come to know.} Allah’s statement, ^And when you see those who engage in false conversation about Our verses (of the Qur’an)}, by denying and mocking them.

The Prohibition of Sitting with Those Who Deny and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1699–1739]

Mock Allah’s Ayat r’--i~ 4 3r*&. frr^ Jy&f istay awayfrom them till they turn to another topic.} until they talk about a subject other than the denial they were engaged in. f &J. fy} 4And ifShaytan causes you toforget...} This command includes every member of this Ummah. No one is to sit with those who deny and distort Allah’s Ayat and explain them incorrectly. If one forgets and sits with such people, 4then after the remembrance sit not you} after you remember, 4in the company of tlwse people who are the wrongdoers.}. A Hadith states, (k^Jl «My Ummah was forgiven unintentional errors, forgetfulness and what they are coerced to do. The Ayah above [6:68] is the Ayah mentioned in Allah’s statement, 111 Ibn Majah 1 :659.

<*\$• tij, 4 Jy 'Si ~S\ v-s* £*£»> 4 !>£y£ -*4" 4And if /ws already been revealed to you in the Book that when you hear the Verses ofAllah being denied and mocked at, then sit not with them, until they engage in a talk other than that; (but if you stayed with them) certainly in that case you would be like them.} [4:140], for, if you still sit with them, agreeing to what they say, you will be just like them. Allah’s statement, 4*0* 0* ->l Oi iyiii ZZjM iThere is no responsibility for them upon those who have Taqwa,} means, when the believers avoid sitting with wrongdoers in this case, they will be innocent of them and they will have saved themselves from their sin. Allah’s statement, ibut (their duty) is to remind them, that they may avoid that.}, means, We commanded you to ignore and avoid them, so that they become aware of the error they are indulging in, that they may avoid this behavior and never repeat it again. & <5 Q*If Xfc <&a fci & "3 jll ifi Ci J-J els' Cj ijf ^ ji ^ 'U <70. And /eaue alone those who take their religion as play and amusement, and are deceived by the life of this world. But remind (them) with it (the Qur’an) lest a soul Tubsal for that which one has earned, when he will find for himself no protector or intercessor besides Allah, and even ifhe offers every ransom, it will not be accepted from him. Such are they who are given up to destruction because of that which they have earned. For them uhll be a drink of boiling water and a painful

379Surah 6. Al-An'dm (70) (Part-7) torment because they used to disbelieve . Allah said, £5 CJ &3& 4A«d leave alone those who take their religion as play and amusement, and are deceived by the life of this world.} The Ayah commands to leave such people, ignore them and give them respite, for soon, they will taste a tremendous torment. This is why Allah said, iBut remind with it} meaning, remind the people with this Qur’an and warn them against Allah’s revenge and painful torment on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said; Ct£2£3 ilest a soul Tubsalfor that which one has earned,} meaning, so that it is

not Tubsal. Ad-Qahhak from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi said that Tubsal means, be submissive.¹¹¹ Al-Walibi said that Ibn 'Abbas said that Tubsal means, 'be exposed'.¹²¹ Qatadah said that Tubsal means, be prevented',¹³¹ Murrah and Ibn Zayd said that it means, be recompensed',¹⁴¹ Al-Kalbi said, be reckoned'.¹⁵¹ All these statements and expressions are similar, for they all mean exposure to destruction, being kept away from all that is good, and being restrained from attaining what is desired. Allah also said; {Every person is restrained by what he has earned. Except those on the Right.} [74:38-39], and {Ij 'hfi '-VI* Oi& At-Tabari 11 :443. 121 At-Tabari 11 :444. At-Tabari 11 :443. At-Tabari 11 :443. At-Tabari 11 :444.

381 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (71 - 73) (Part-7 is He to Whom you shall be gathered> 473. It is He Who has created the heavens and the earth in truth, and on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become. His Word is the truth. His will be the dominion on the Day when the Sur will be blown. All-Knower of the unseen and the seen. He is the All-Wise, Well-Aware> The Parable of Those Who Revert to Disbelief After Faith and Good Deeds As-Suddi said, "Some idolators said to some Muslims, 'Follow us and abandon the religion of Muhammad.' Allah sent down the revelation, Sjjj I:.. is V £ ji ijwul j»^ 4 Say: "Shall we invoke others besides Allah, that can do us neither good nor harm, and shall we turn on our heels..."⁴ by reverting to disbelief, 4" • .after Allah has guided us? for if we do this, our example will be like he whom the devils have caused to wander in confusion throughout the land. Allah says here, your example, if you revert to disbelief after you believed, is that of a man who went with some people on a road, but he lost his way and the devils led him to wander in confusion over the land. Meanwhile, his companions on the road were calling him to come to them saying, 'Come back to us, for we are on the path.' But, he refused to go back to them. This is the example of he who follows the devil after recognizing Muhammad and Muhammad is the person who is calling the people to the path, and the path is Islam." Ibn Jarir recorded this statement.' Allah's statement, 4 Like one whom the Shayattn (devils) have made to go astray (wandering) through the land, refers to ghouls, m At-Tabari 11 :452.

^calling him} by his name, his father's and his grandfather's names. So he follows the devils' call thinking that it is a path of guidance, but by the morning he will find himself destroyed and perhaps they eat him. The Jinns will then let him wander in a wasteland where he will die of thirst. This is the example of those who follow the false gods that are being worshipped instead of Allah, Most Honored. Ibn Jarir also recorded this J Allah said, ji j'A i Say: "Verily, Allah's guidance is the only guidance,"} Allah said in other instances, 4 J-4 <£> } } And whomsoever Allah guides, for him there will be none to misguide him.} [39:371, and, i 1 * Z ilf you covet for their guidance, then verily Allah guides not those whom He makes to go astray. And they will have no helpers.} [17:37] Allah's statement, iAA A, 'xA&y3} i and we have been commanded to submit to the Lord of all that exists.} means, we were commanded to worship Allah in sincerity to Him alone, without partners. i And to perform the Salah, and have Taqwa of Him.} meaning, we were commanded to perform the prayer and to fear Allah in all circumstances, A ttJ%} [ii At-Tabari 11:452.

383 Surah 6. Al-An'am (71 - 73) (Part-7) i and it is He to Whom you shall be gathered.} on the Day of Resurrection. ^ ^%} it is He Who has created the heavens and the earth in truth.} meaning, in justice, and He is their Originator and Owner Who governs their affairs and the affairs of their inhabitants. Allah said, 4 and on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become.} Referring to the Day of Resurrection,

which will come faster than the blink of an eye, when Allah says to it, 'Be.' As-Sur; The Trumpet Allah's statement, 4 £} ion the Day when the Sur will be blown.. } refers to His statement, iand on the Day He will say: "Be!" it shall become.} as we stated above. Or, it means, i)&\ 4&£ Jjj\$%} iHis will be the dominion on the Day when the Sur will be blown.} Allah said in other Aydt, ij&X a jyS cfi} iWhose is the kingdom this Day? It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!} (40:16), and, iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty), belonging to the Most Beneficent (Allah), and it will be a hard Dayfor the disbelievers.} [25:26] The Sur is the Trumpet into which the angel Isr&fil, peace be

y osssm vrv gap V,upon him, will blow. 'ss A*- t ' The Messenger of Allah jg said, ^<^£L* <X-^LjjSbJ jji jj£j| J jji^,| »: j; ^3 «£ki 1xi ^ «Israfil has held the Sur in !'?. TMD J< rzZ'^rfZZ ,zz.,Z.ZZ,,, "»* /i,s TMT- TjJa JljajSjjCullU ICJlI2^ CiJCalf itig the command to blow <*s* - -, •Csn'Z>'z, 1 in if." ^ ^ ^ Muslim recorded this Hadlth in his JS.Zy.liUj^ recorded that xdu o^IS.jSjdi('Abdullah bin 'Amr 'Z<*Z ."*> - Z ,*,Z,Z~Z said, "A bedouin man said, 'O Allah's 'StezCStd 1 Messenger! What is ' ' ^ the Sur?' He said, 'Z=zz ^Z\Z&y&j^3fZlZ^Z- i4_j i Tmmtu>t mhirh mill"A Trumpet tohich will be blown J'^2] t^U> tj ~£t*yj tibjl ^ i||l» UU! -UoJ jji» JG 4^^ UJi ui t^jVlj o/ji Sj'yjr i:j ds 4-J ^ jCi >1 ui ui jg *&^ •«y ill* Jj jj-f; Ujl J5 Ji! ll£ cij ui JG IjyC Ui t^> JG cJil UJi jv£==»1 Uk jj Uu JG iijC 1.1i 4£§> dsi "0 £> U;j»- Z(H JJ. 474. And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father Azar : "Do you take idols as gods? Verily, I see you and your people 111 At-Tabari 5:238. 121 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:117, Ahmad 2 : 162

in manifest error."} 475. Thus did we show Ibrahim the kingdom of the heavens and the earth that he be one of those who havefaith with certainty.} 476. When the night overcame him he saw a Kawkab. He said: "This is my lord." But when it Afala, he said: "I like not those that set."} 477. When he saw the moon rising up, he said: "This is my lord. But when it set, he said: "Unless my Lord guides me, I shall surely be among the misguided people."} 478. When he saw the sun rising up, he said: "This is my lord. This is greater." But when it Afalat, he said: "O my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners in worship with Allah .} 479. Verily, I have turned my face towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth, Hanifan, and I am not of the idolators."} Ibrahim Advises his Father Ibrahim advised, discouraged and forbade his father from worshipping idols, just as Allah stated, <2# CCJ jji: ju \\j} 4And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father Azar: "Do you take idols as gods?"} meaning, do you worship an idol instead of Allah? 4Verily, I see you and your people...} who follow your path, 4\$4 4^ 4in manifest error} wandering in confusion unaware of where to go. Therefore, you are in disarray and ignorance, and this fact is clear to all those who have sound reason. Allah also said,

'-11, df^t & v'j® •^—*i ^ \$% J J*bb^^ ft £\$-S 2&\$£ ic*J *Sjb vt 5^~ jj ijMS *i' i>j >j £» j^4j«-1» *4 ;w.t. 4A«d mention in the Book (the Qur'an, the story of) Ibrahim. Verily! He was a man of truth, a Prophet. When he said to his father: "O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything? O my father! Verily! There has come to me ofknowledge that which came not unto you. So follow me. I will guide you to a straight path. O my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily! Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Beneficent (Allah). O my father! Verily! I fear lest a torment from the Most Beneficent (Allah) overtakes you, so that you become a companion of Shaytan (in the Hell- fire)." He (the father) said: "Do you reject my gods, O Ibrahim? Ifyou stop not (this), I will indeed stone you. So get awayfrom me safely before I punish you." Ibrahim said: "Peace be on you! I

will ask forgiveness of my Lord for you. Verily! He is unto me, Ever Most Gracious. And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call on my Lord; and I hope that I shall not be unanswered in my invocation to my Lord." [19:41-48] Ibrahim continued asking for forgiveness for his father for the rest of his father's life. When his father died an idolator and Ibrahim realized this fact, he stopped asking Allah for forgiveness for him and disassociated himself from him. Allah said, "And invoking for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he had made to him. But when it became clear to him that he was an enemy to Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily Ibrahim was patient in supplication and forbearing. [9:114].

It was recorded in the Sahih that Ibrahim will meet his father Azar on the Day of Resurrection and Azar will say to him, "My son! This Day, I will not disobey you." Ibrahim will say, "O Lord! You promised me not to disgrace me on the Day they are resurrected; and what will be more disgraceful to me than cursing and dishonoring my father?" Then Allah will say, "O Ibrahim! Look behind you!" He will look and there he will see (that his father was changed into) a male hyena covered in dung, which will be caught by the legs and thrown in the (Hell) Fire." [11] Tawhid Becomes Apparent to Ibrahim Allah's statement, "Thus did I show Ibrahim the kingdom of the heavens and the earth..." [6:75], means, when he contemplated about the creation of the heaven and earth, We showed Ibrahim the proofs of Allah's Oneness over His dominion and His creation, which indicate that there is no god or Lord except Allah. Allah said in other Ayat, "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth." [10:101], and, "See they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth? If We will, We sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the sky to fall upon them. Verily, in this is a sign for every servant who turns to Allah." [34:9] Allah said next, Path Al-Bdri 6:445. There are a number of reasons explained for this incident, among them, that Ibrahim will not feel disgraced by seeing a dung-covered hyena thrown in the Fire, and that this is the true worth of his father. See the reference given for more comments

When the night overcame him, he covered him with darkness, and he saw a star. He said: "This is my lord" But when it set, he said, "This is not my lord." Qatadah commented, "Ibrahim knew that his Lord is Eternal and never ceases." When he saw the moon rising up, he said: "This is my lord." But when it set, he said: "Unless my Lord guides me, I shall surely be among the misguided people." When he saw the sun rising up, he said: "This is my lord." This radiating, rising star is my lord, and this is greater than the star and the moon, and more so. But when it set, he said: "O my people! I am indeed free from all that you join as partners in worship with Allah. Verily, I have turned my face..." meaning, I have purified my religion and made my worship sincere, as At-Jabari 1:480

"towards Him Who has created the heavens and the earth," Who originated them and shaped them without precedence, Hanifan, avoiding Shirk and embracing Tawhid. This is why he said next, "and I am not of the idolaters." Prophet Ibrahim Debates with his People We should note here that, in these Ayat, Ibrahim, peace be upon him, was debating with his people, explaining to them the error of their way in worshipping idols and images. In the first case with his father, Ibrahim explained to his people their error in worshipping the idols of earth, which they made in the shape of heavenly angels, so that

they intercede on their behalf with the Glorious Creator. His people thought that they are too insignificant to worship Allah directly, and this is why they turned to the worship of angels as intercessors with Allah for their provisions, gaining victory and attaining their various needs. He then explained to them the error and deviation of worshipping the seven planets, which they said were the Moon, Mercury, Venus, the Sun, Mars, Jupiter and Saturn. The brightest of these objects and the most honored to them was the Sun, the Moon then Venus. Ibrahim, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him, first proved that Venus is not worthy of being worshipped, for it is subservient to a term and course appointed that it does not defy, nor swerving right or left. Venus does not have any say in its affairs, for it is only a heavenly object that Allah created and made bright out of His wisdom. Venus rises from the east and sets in the west where it disappears from sight. This rotation is repeated the next night, and so forth. Such an object is not worthy of being a god. Ibrahim then went on to mention the Moon in the same manner in which he mentioned Venus, and then the Sun. When he proved that these three objects were not gods,

391 Surah 6. Al-An'am (80 - 83) (Part-7) Jr ossmz 'rA A r-? j££l3'* i^ I ^ ^ ^ -i Z' ^ *. /f.X #/• L>-^jl^j-XJb j^L s>u>yuuJjlr***-Jy4) CwJbj •>»/ *1 >/'*** >' <> *' } (jCy~>uJ*£j£ 0J^ ^J i—A—*yJ §1 ti*UL 'M^A^saj U»jJ_) j^jkI* T,j S'~"i'h c •./ » « f/,^ » " ^ 'T^rf P^jpeWj jo^JlitijiiiU.'S -at .* i Jv^Lg fr> .H.4 ju>Zr\$A\$>\^ \$<£*£%£&&& gogtt These Ayat indicate that Ibrahim was debating with his people about the Shirk they practiced. 4&& fe li kjli3 *Jj 4jl»JL6 jij ait 4; as oi Vi - fa* „> j^=. 1 uu£=>j jj^£=>jcj yjl ^ (2 & ^=Ci1 j£ p C it ^*,1 j^3i & fa"i s •V *f> r<=t-:>f- *<“{ iff <_ '1 •{£ cl^ £1 iri.pt jj) (>'''* <!£\$' J^ojjijbd £ iiji Ji 4^1 ££ lilij l^UX-Ja (**> jOlt ?' d6 -*iijil '-Ajli < X ** > u* *- *•-> 4^^ iii J%> ‘-r’? < X ox c •; 01 4>* £*J> *A*y 480. His people disputed with him. He said: “Do you dispute with me about Allah while He has guided me, and I fear not those whom you associate with Allah in worship. (Nothing can happen to me) except when my Lord wills something. My Lord comprehends in His knowledge all things. Will you not then remember?” 481. And how should I fear those whom you associate in worship with Allah, while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah things for which He has not sent down to you any Sultan.(So) which of the two parties has more right to be in security? If you but know.” 482 . It is those who believe and confuse not their belief with

392 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Zulm (wrong), for them (only) there is security and they are the guided.} 483 . And that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We in degrees raise whom We will. Certainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} Allah states that His KhalU, Prophet Ibrahim, said when his people mentioned various doubts and disputed with him about the Tawhid that he called to: it . i-l -."if V -Xjj 4ji\ J* f 4Do you dispute with me about Allah while He has guided me?}. The Ayah means, do you argue with me about Allah, other than Whom there is no god worthy of worship, while He has guided me to the Truth and made me aware of it? Therefore, how can I ever consider your misguided statements and false doubts? Ibrahim said next, ol Vi ^ ^j} iand I fear not those whom you associate with Allah in worship. (Nothing can happen to me) except when my Lord wills something.} Ibrahim said, among the proofs to the falsehood of your creed, is that these false gods that you worship do not bring about any effect, and I do not fear them or care about them. Therefore, if these gods are able to cause harm, then use them against me and do not give me respite. Ibrahim's statement, 4&~£ Lp ^ ^j} iexcept when my Lord wills something.} means, only Allah causes benefit or harm. 4My Lord

comprehends in His knowledge all things.} meaning, Allah's knowledge encompasses all things and nothing escapes His complete observation, *\$} iWill you not then remember?}

393 Surah 6. Al-An'am (80 - 83) (Part-7) what I explained to you, considering your idols as false gods and refraining from worshipping them? This reasoning from Prophet Ibrahim is similar to the argument that Prophet Had used against his people, 'Ad. Allah mentioned this incident in His Book, when He said, 'iXSj-t V' Jji I* Ai> <jj ij* ciSS' d] Wf ')->-*\$* 'AJ-5 i>; .4,0^3 lli 4 -* Jj/-? j@ 3j a] J* &> Ot iThey said: "O Hud! No evidence have you brought us, and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you . All that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil." He said: "I call Allah to witness - and bear you witness - that I am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship with Him (Allah). So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path (the truth)."} [11:53-56] Ibrahim's statement, t* >jU-1 iAnd how should I fear those whom you associate. . .} means, how should I fear the idols that you worship instead of Allah, 3% ? cA JZ&p %} {while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah things for which He has not sent down to you any Sultan.} meaning, proof, according to Ibn 'Abbas and others among the Salaf. 111 Allah said in similar Ayat, Si (4 {Or have they partners who have instituted for them a religion which Allah has not allowed?} [42:21], and, m At-Tabari 1 1 :491

4A £ ip:oM 4It is those who believe and confuse not their belief with Zulm (wrong,) it was hard on the people. They said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Who among us did not commit Zulm against himself?' He said, £jlSji ju u \jLai /dJJo ^jJi ^4J Jjj> tit is not what you understood from it. Did you not hear what the righteous servant (Luqmdn) said, 4%A £>\ \$i i '(£>) <0 my son! Join not in worship others with Allah. Verily! Shirk is a great Zulm (xorong) indeed.)* [31:13]. Therefore, it is about Shirk. Allah's statement. 4+3& &,) 4And that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people.) means, We directed him to proclaim Our proof against them. Mujahid and others said that 'Our proof refers to. 3% p c p zid 4\$% i&Ji\$ 4And how should I fear those whom you associate in worship with Allah (though they can neither benefit nor harm), while you fear not that you have joined in worship with Allah things for which He has not sent down to you any Sultan. (So) which of the two parties has more right to be in security?)"™ Allah has testified Ibrahim's statement and affirmed security and guidance, saying; 4 & j£i: 4It is those who believe and confuse not their belief with Zulm, Ahmad 1 :444. 121 AMabari 11:505.

396 Tafsir Ibt Kathir far them there is security and they are the guided.} Allah said, iAnd that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We raise in degrees whom We will.} And; jx; iCertainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} He is All-Wise in His statements and actions, All-Knower of those whom He guides or misguides, and whether the proof was established against them or not. Allah also said, iTruly! Those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them - until they see the painful torment.} [10:96-97] This is why Allah said here, iCertainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing.} 'ii-iA OJJ Jr* Jt LJjS i-jjiJoj j'lj Cf& OJ Zs*y3 «-*—.£> & u£ \$\$ £& £ y Jdij • J*>s dl. fZ&j rjfa/3 'X ^ >4^ -Lfa jjj •***'4c Oi iUa a* 'tf. SXf, ^ »#JJ* <4 v, ! & % u&& d& 4 ktiM c&n \$zc 4 i4* ^ JJ i+jji iif L {(\$ Jb)j! V^jiox^SC 4 > 4S4. And We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub, each of them We guided, and before him, We

guided Niih and among his progeny Ddwud, Sulaymdn, Ayyub, Yusuf, Musa, and Hdriin. Thus do We reward the good-doers.}

485. And Zakariyyd, and Yahyd and 'Isa and Iliyas, each one of them was of the righteous . 486. And Isma'il and Al-Yasa', and Yunus and Lut, and each one of them We preferred above the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns, of their times).} 487. And also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethren, We chose them, and We guided them to a straight path.} 488. This is the guidance of Allah with which He guides whomsoever He wills of His servants. But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that they used to do would have been of no benefit to them.} 489. They are those whom We gave the Book, Al-Hukm, and prophethood. But if they disbelieve therein, then, indeed We have entrusted it to a people who are not disbelievers therein.} 490. They are those whom Allah had guided. So follow their guidance. Say : "No reward I ask of you for this (the Qur'an). It is only a reminder for the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns)." Ibrahim Receives the News of Ishaq and Ya'qub During His Old Age Allah states that after Ibrahim became old and he, and his wife, Sarah, lost hope of having children, He gave them Ishaq. The angels came to Ibrahim on their way to the people of Prophet Lut (to destroy them) and they delivered the good news of a child to Ibrahim and his wife. Ibrahim's wife was amazed at the news, \$8 tc-i ^3 yz 0; 'A 47§U 5* 'A /& 4She said (in astonishment): "Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband, an old man? Verily! This is a strange thing!" They said: "Do you wonder at the decree of Allah? The mercy of Allah and His blessings be on you, O the family [of Ibrahim]. Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All-Glorious."} (11:72-73) The angels also gave them the good news that Ishaq will be a

3&L Tafsir Ibn Kathir Prophet and that he will have offspring of his own. In another Ayah, Allah said; iAnd We gave him the good news of Ishaq a Prophet from the righteous.}[37:112), which perfects this good news and completes the favor. Allah said, iof Ishaq, and after him, of Ya'qub...} [11:71), meaning, this child will have another child in your lifetime, so that your eyes are comforted by him, just as your eyes will be comforted by his father. Certainly, one becomes jubilant and joyous when he becomes a grandfather, because this means that his offspring will continue to exist. It was also expected that if an elderly couple had children, due to the child's weakness, he would have no offspring. This is why Allah delivered the good news of Ishaq and of his son Ya'qub, whose name literally means 'multiplying and having offspring'. This was a reward for Ibrahim who left his people and migrated from their land so that he could worship Allah alone. Allah compensated Ibrahim with better than his people and tribe when He gave him righteous children of his own, who would follow his religion, so that his eyes would be comforted by them. In another Ayah, Allah said; iSo when he turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one of them We made a Prophet.} [19:49] Allah said here, iAnd We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub, each of them We guided,} Allah said; Ji Cjlm. li-yj} iand before him. We guided Nuh...}

399 Surah 6. Al-An'am (84 - 90) (Part-7 meaning, We guided NQh before and gave him righteous offspring, just as We guided Ibrahim and gave him righteous children. Qualities of Nuh and Ibrahim Each of these two Prophets had special qualities. When Allah caused the people of the earth to drown, except those who believed in Nuh and accompanied him in the ark, Allah made the offspring of NQh the dwellers of the earth thereafter. Ever since that occurred, the people of the earth were and still are

the descendants of NQh. As for Ibr&hlm, Allah did not send a Prophet after him but from his descendants. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd We ordained among his (Ibrahim's) offspring prophethood and the Book.} [29:27], iAnd indeed, We sent Nuh and Ibrahim, and placed in their offspring Prophethood and the Book.} [57:26], and. !*5»- (ifc ty (Mi i iThose were they unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam, and of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Niih, and of the offspring of Ibrahim and Isrd'il andfrom among (hose whom We guided and chose. When the verses of the Most Beneficent (Allah) were recited unto them, they fell down prostrating and weeping.} [19:58] Allah said in this honorable Ayah here, ofi} iand among his progeny...} meaning, We guided from among his offspring. »</>}

iDawud, Sulaymdn...) from the offspring of Nuh, according to Ibn Jarir.' It is also possible that the Ayah refers to Ibrahim since it is about him that the blessings were originally mentioned here, although Lut is not from his offspring, for he was Ibrahim's nephew, the son of his brother Maran, the son of Azar. It is possible to say that Lilt was mentioned in Ibrahim's offspring as a generalization. As Allah said, iljJ ijN5 i>jX. m U ojlit iOr were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub? When he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, "We shall worship your God, and the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Ishaq, One God, and to Him we submit") [2:133]. Here, Ismail was mentioned among the ascendants of Ya'qub, although he was Ya'qub's uncle. Similarly Allah said, j \$ S4it iSo the angels prostrated themselves, all of them together. Except Iblis - he refused to be among those to prostrate.) [15:30-31]. Allah included Iblis in His order to the angels to prostrate, and chastised him for his opposition, all because he was similar to them in that (order), so he was considered among them in general, although he was a Jinn. Iblis was created from fire while the angels were created from light. Mentioning Isa in the offspring of Ibrahim, or NQh as we stated above, is proof that the grandchildren from a man's daughter's side are included among his offspring, isa is included among Ibrahim's progeny through his mother, although Isa did not have a father. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Harb bin Abi Al- Aswad said, "Al-Hajjaj sent to Yahya bin Ya'mar, saying, 1 was told that you claim that Al-Hasan and Al-Husayn are from the offspring of the Prophet did you find it in the Book ofAllah? I read the Qur'an from beginning to end and did not find it.' Yahya said, Do you not read in SuratAl-An'&m, hi At-Jabari 11 :507.

<J?j} iattd among his progeny Dawud, Sulaymdn . . .} until, &} }and Yahyd and 'Isa...} Al-Hajjaj said, "Yes.' Yahya said, 'Is not 'Isa from the offspring of Ibrahim, although he did not have a father?' Al-Hajjaj said, "You have said the truth." For example, when a man leaves behind a legacy, a trust, or gift to his "offspring" then the children of his daughters are included. But if a man gives something to his "sons", or he leaves a trust behind for them, then that would be particular to his male children and their male children. Allah's statement, rri>/> hti} iAnd also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethren,} (6:87], mentions that some of these Prophets' ascendants and descendants were also guided and chosen. So Allah said, }We chose them, and We guided than to a straight path.} Shirk Eradicates the Deeds, Even the Deeds of the Messengers Allah said next, / l / * fx" " ** ** '>' 'Y cn j4 jJl,-. jut iSjj iThis is the guidance of Allah with which He guides whomsoever He wills ofHis servants.} meaning, this occurred to them by Allah's leave and because He directed them to guidance. Allah said; Yffc d Ip ij\$il fj} }But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3:311.

403 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (84 - 90) (Part-7 4Jhey...) refers to the people of Makkah, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Ad-pahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi, and others.¹¹¹ i then, indeed We have entrusted it to a people who are not disbelievers therein .} This Ayah means, if the Quraysh and the rest of the people of the earth - Arabs and non-Arabs, illiterate and the People of the Scripture - disbelieve in these bounties, then We have entrusted them to another people, the Muhajirfln and Ansar, and those who follow their lead until the Day of Resurrection, iwho are not disbelievers therein.} They will not deny any of these favors, not even one letter. Rather, they will believe in them totally, even the parts that are not so clear to some of them. We ask Allah to make us among them by His favor, generosity and kindness. Addressing His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sg, Allah said; iThey are...} the Prophets mentioned here, along with their righteous fathers, offspring and bretheren, 4til tiJk jM} 4those whom Allah had guided.} meaning, they alone are the people of guidance, 4So follow their guidance.} Imitate them. This command to the Messenger jg certainly applies to his Ummah, according to what he legislates and commands them. While mentioning this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Mujahid asked Ibn 'Abbas, "Is there an instance where prostration is warranted in [Surah] Sad?" Ibn 'Abbas said, "Yes." He then recited, m At-T&bari 11 :515,516.

Ij assail \r* 80\$) y is ***• *jj-ajL* _j *Aj«Wi£j1 f<_«i^! *Jj^dr43 <* / > '*.' AX ' > '>' ?,X^X •' -" , '*',<A jJ^S^oAJ*Cr^lQ^pjlJU*5^ JlijtJJS^if 1j}y£ JjitUJji, ""t"* \ --^ >\r %?•'/4^) > "%€*** ^ < a^ < . "» »>V <£*> ^ A ^j] ^ 4 • .And We bestowed upon him Ishaq and Ya'qub...} until, ifj^il 4 • •So follow guidance. ^ He commented, "He (our Prophet, Muhammad jg) was among them." In another narration, Mujahid added that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Your Prophet sg was among those whose guidance we were commanded to follow."^ * Allah's statement, 4&i£p& i ji» iSay : "No reward I ask ofvou for this."} means, I do not ask you for any reward for delivering the Qur'an to you, nor anything else, &M \$i£ i"It is only a reminderfor the 'Alamin (mankind and Jinns)."} so they are reminded by it and guided from blindness to clarity, from misguidance to guidance, and from disbelief to faith. their i£jK Cj* J* £s" j; y" j* Jjil l* i)lli ij j>- iiiijyi Cj} Fath Al-B&ri 8 : 144 . The reference is to no . 24 ofSad (38) where it is mentioned that Dawud , peace be upon him , prostrated . Since Allah ordered following what they were guided to in these Ayat of Al- An'am, then we should also prostrate at the mention of the Prophets prostrations , according to Ibn 'Abbas

U /iVj SM) 'jj> Cs~y 'it *V C5S5 4 (XfiX&jJ&c^ il \$ (Uj 54*3* o4*j» u{Jt> i-ij*- i>*j ^ i* j\$ 4^z£& 491. They did not estimate Allah with an estimation due to Him when they said: "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration) ." Say : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind which you (the Jews) have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing much. And you were taught that which neither you nor your fathers knew." Say: "Allah (sent it down)." Then leave them to play in their vain discussions.} 492. And this is a blessed Book which We have sent down, confirming wlvwt came before it, so that you may warn the Mother of Towns and all those around it. Those who believe in the Hereafter believe in it, and they are constant in guarding their Saldh.} The Messenger is but aHuman toWhom the Book was Revealedby Inspiration Allah says that those who rejected His Messengers did not give Allah due consideration. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and 'Abdullah bin Kathir said that this Ayah was revealed about the Quraysh. 1 ' 1 It was also said that it was revealed about some Jews. 0; & «» 4/1 ^ 4They said: "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration)."} Allah also, said, 4Is it a

wonder for mankind that We have inspired to a man from among themselves (saying): "Want mankind."} (10:2], and, m At-Tabari 11 :524.

406 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir jj & % 3\$ oi^ s^fl fZr l\ && J jtff£ Cj} ff 4 i&£> £=£ £Sjf ^ vsg3 4 sr ^And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said: "Has AllSh sent a man as Messenger?" Say: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security, We should certainly have sent down for them from the heaven an angel as a Messenger."} (17:94-95). AllSh said here, 4JUT jj ri) «Sl Jjil U jfc ill IjjJi 477iey did not estimate Allah with an estimation due to Him when they said : "Nothing did Allah send down to any human being (by inspiration)."} AllSh answered them, iU&&&*S &&#Z& iSay : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind?"} meaning, say, O Muhammad jg, to those who deny the concept that AllSh sent down Books by revelation, answering them specifically, iWho then sent down the Book which Musa brought?} in reference to the Tawrah that you and all others know that AllSh sent down to MQsS, son of Imran. AllSh sent the Tawrah as a light and a guidance for people, so that it could shed light on the answers to various disputes, and to guide away from the darkness of doubts. Allah's statement, o&j t£»£? fi£%} iwhich you have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much).} means, you made the Tawrah into separate sheets which you copied from the original and altered, changed and distorted as

407 Surah 6. Al-An'am (91 - 92) (Part-7) you wished. You then said, "this is from Allah," meaning it is in the revealed Book of Allah, when in fact, it is not from Allah. This is why Allah said here, iwhich you have made into (separate) papersheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much).} Allah said; iAnd you were taught that which neither you nor your fathers knew.} meaning, Who sent down the Qur'an in which Allah taught you the news of those who were before you and the news of what will come after, that neither you nor your fathers had knowledge of. Allah's statement, iSay: "Allah."} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Meaning, "Say, Allah sent it down." Allah said, rx+r- 4 (*»j> *»? {Then leave them to play in their vain discussions.} leave them to play in ignorance and misguidance until the true news comes to them from Allah. Then, they will know whether the good end is theirs or for the fearful servants of Allah. Allah said. iAnd Otis is a Book,} the Qur'an, iif/R P 1»M is <34*** 4& &\$} iBlessed, which We have sent down, confirming which came before it, so that you may warn the Mother of Towns} that is, Makkah, & ifiJ iand all those around it...} refering to the Arabs and the rest of the children of Adam, Arabs and non-Arabs alike. Allah said in other Ayat,

iiZJ: U iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah."> [7:158], and 4\$ oo 4"that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.'y [6:19], and iBut those of the sects who reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place [11:17] and, iff-& oU/d' Sj> AjC] 4Blessed be He Who sent down the criterion to His servant that he may be a wamer to the 'Alamlñ (mankind and Jinn)y [25:1], and. UM. 4}Cii % j#(<And say to those who were given the Scripture and to those who are illiterates: "Do you submit yourselves?" If they do, they are rightly guided ; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message; and Allah is All-Seer of (His) servantsy [3:20]. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, that the Messenger of Allah M said, ;dVi ji it! tf&x jU uui c-kpfs "I have been given five things which were not given to any one else before me :*> The Prophet jg mentioned among these five

things, isiip c-i tiiU- <jiSj "Every Prophet was sent only to his nation, but I have been sent to all peoples Fath Al-Bari no .5 19 , Muslim 1 : 370.

This is why Allah said, iThose who believe in the Hereafter believe in it,} meaning, those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, believe in this blessed Book, the Qur'an, which We revealed to you, O Muhammad jig, & fit iand they are constant in guarding their Salah.} for they perform what Allah ordered them, offering the prayers perfectly and bn time. J>L, JtS £j> pj Z}{ J* \$ C-i^" a*-, ffi-j-iJ 4 ijJL 'lal l ISjj jlj <!' U jit pr Ct of &Z dSfi '\$ \$>> }j*\$ pSSit <X u* jui tjg* sJ; p:& Cj / s- , >>*. <v 493. And who can be more unjust than he who invents a lie against Allah, or says: "I have received inspiration," whereas he is not inspired in anything; and who says, "I will reveal the like of what Allah has revealed." And if you could but see when the wrongdoers are in the agonies of death, while the angels are stretching forth their hands (saying) : ",Deliver your souls! This day you shall be recompensed with the torment of degradation because of what you used to utter against Allah other than the truth. And you used to reject His Aydt with disrespect!"} 494. And truly you have come unto Us alone, as We created you the first time. You have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you. We see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed to be your partners. Now you and they have been cut off, and all that you used to claim has vanished from you.}

suffering from the hardships, agonies and afflictions of death, iwhile the angels are stretching forth their hands...) beating them. Allah said in other Ayat. 4If you do stretch your hand against me to kill me..) [5:28]and, 4£\ j£Z) 4And stretch forth their hands and their tongues against you with eyes<7.^(60:2j Ad-Dahhak and Abu Salih said that, 'stretch forth their hands,' means, 'with torment'.111 In another Ayah, Allah said, Jy-i *1 5^ 4And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve they smite their faces and their backs.}[8:50] Allah said, iwhile the angels are stretching forth their hands) beating them, until their souls leave their bodies, saying, i"Deliver your souls!") When the disbeliever is near death, the angels will convey the 'good news' to him of torment, vengeance, chains, restraints, Hell, boiling water and the singer of the Most Beneficent, Most Merciful. The soul will then scatter in the body of the disbeliever and refuse to get out of it. The angels will keep beating the disbeliever until his soul exits from his body, i(Saying): "Deliver your souls! This day you shall be recompensed with the torment of degradation because of what Al-Tabari 1 1 :539

422 Tafslr Ibrt Kathir you used to say about Allah other than the truth.") This Ayah means, today, you will be utterly humiliated because you used to invent lies against Allah and arrogantly refused to follow His Aydt and obey His Messengers. There are many Hadlths, of Mutawati^ grade, that explain what occurs when the believers and disbelievers die, and we will mention these Hadlths when explaining Allah's statement, P-' 4 SA ip* PiJ' iif iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter.) [14:27] Allah said next, iAnd truly you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time.) [6:94], and this statement will be said on the Day of Return. In another Ayah, Allah said, s) iAnd they will be set before your Lord in rows, (and Allah will say) : "Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time.) [18:48], meaning, just as We started your creation, We brought you back, although you used to deny Resurrection and reject its possibility. Therefore, this is the Day of Resurrection! Allah said, iYou have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you.) [6:94], The wealth and the money that you collected in the life of the

world, you left all this behind you. It is recorded in the Sahih that Allah's Messenger said, c-ijj jf icJliti cJs\ t; M[iuu JA Jjj pal i£\ A Hadtth reported by numerous routes, having many different narrators at each level of every chain

•^QJ iSjt'iJ JLi iSj-r ^ 'oLiiti iThe Son of Adam says, 'My money, my money!' But, what part of your money do you have, other than what you eat of it and is thus spent, what you wear and tear and what you gave in charity and thus remains (in the record of good deeds)? Other than that, you will depart and leave it to the people.»[11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "On the Day of Resurrection, the Son of Adam will be brought, as if he were a golden chariot and Allah, the Most Honored, will ask, 'Where is what you collected?' He will reply, 'O Lord! I collected it and left it as intact as ever.' Allah will say to him, 'O Son of Adam! Where is what you sent forth for yourself (of righteous, good deeds),' and he will realize that he did not send forth anything for himself." Al-Hasan then recited the Ayah, ftP& «s & 4And truly you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time. You have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement. Allah said; iW&p sj;pzz pi& c;} 4We see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed to be your partners.} This chastises and criticizes the disbelievers for the rivals, idols and images that they worshipped in this life, thinking they will avail them in this life and upon Resurrection, if there is Resurrection, as they thought. On the Day of Resurrection, all relationships will be cut off, misguidance will be exposed, and those whom they used to call upon as gods will disappear from them. Allah will then call them, while the rest of creation is listening, ^ S# i&i j)} iWhere are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?} (28:62] And, ' I * Muslim 4: 2273.

ypxspj^ ^ .yJ lbii>Ji it:£iS; ^/ /,/ ,H,jC' >- > *1 / . < !/'?*" LfrJu^j6yl>oi^l'ji_juii o'>4 \$^a#4? iLt-JpJOj >•*^-*rr^ 'j*A? jd>,jJu^3 ujf>jV'j f \^4Then, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another.) [23:101], and 'tJl di' oji Jt JXJ^i Cj\ tSitf opsi 4 fp ;£ shall have no helper.) [29:25], and %*\$&)&\$& Jt j, ^s») Uj jlll' 4You have taken (for worship) idols instead of Allah, and the love between you is only in the life of this world, but on

the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you iAnd it will be said (to them) : "Call upon your partners", and they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them.) [28:64], and 4And the Day whereon We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who committed Shirk...) [10:28] until, \jit tf fr XSj> 4And their invented false deities will vanish from them.) [10:30]

416 Tafsir Ibri Kathir iit ,£J'i ji y-pf 9p' o; 5-' jvi >li' o!> 2if j# 5m? •& ^35 o^J'j (^ j# JSK^ ,3>> @Sj3? \$ 3 J35 2<^ 4 % W23 j£3rf £3 43.4f# 495. Verily! It is Allah Who causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout. He brings forth the living from the dead, and it is He Who brings forth the dead from the living. Such is Allah, then how are you deluded away from the truth?} i96. (He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} 497. It is He Who has set the stars for you, so that you may guide your course with their help through the darkness of the land and the sea. We have (indeed) explained in detail Our Ayat for people who know.} Recognizing Allah Through Some of His Ayat Allah states that He causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout in the ground, producing various types, colors, shapes, and tastes of grains and produce. The Ayah, iWho

causes the seed grain and the fruit stone to split and sprout.} is explained by the next statement, <SfffU U 5“ iHe brings forth the living from the dead, and it is He Who brings forth the deed from the living.} meaning, He brings the living plant from the seed grain and the fruit stone, which is a lifeless and inanimate object. Allah said, iAnd a sign for them is the dead land. We gave it life, and We

417 Surah 6. Al-Ariam (95 - 97) (Part-7) brought forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} [36:33] until, V iL t j c^j} ias well as of their own (human) kind (male and female), and of that which they know not.} [36:36] Allah's statement, cp' iand it is He Wlw brings forth the dead from the living .} There are similar expressions in meaning such as, He brings the egg from the chicken, and the opposite. Others said that it means, He brings the wicked offspring from the righteous parent and the opposite, and there are other possible meanings for the Ayah. Allah said, iSuch is Allah,} meaning, He Who does all this, is Allah, the One and Only without partners, i then how are you deluded away from the truth?} meaning, look how you are deluded from Truth to the falsehood of worshipping others besides Allah. Allah's statement, Jdf ^pi\ \$} i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting,} means, He is the Creator of light and darkness. Allah said in

the beginning of the Surah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1739–1791]

'4And originated the darkness and the light.} Indeed, Allah causes the darkness of the night to disappear and brings forth the day, thus bringing brightness to the world and light to the horizon, while dissipating darkness and "'S ending the night with its depth of darkness and starting the day with its brightness and light. Allah said,

iU- 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly.\$ [7:54] In this Ayah, Allah reminds of His ability to create diversified things in opposites, testifying to His perfect greatness and supreme power. Allah states that He is the Cleaver of the daybreak and mentioned its opposite, when He said, 4<&& &,} 4He has appointed the night for resting,} meaning, created darkness, in order for the creation to become halt and rest during it. Allah said in other Ayat, 4By the forenoon. And by the night when it is still.} [93:1-2], 4By the night as it envelops. And by the day as it appears in brightness.} [92:1,2] and, 4And by the day as it shows up (the sun's) brightness. And by the night as it conceals it.} [91:3-4] Allah's statement, ik /\ 4...And the sun and the moon for reckoning.} means, the sun and the moon have specific orbits, according to a term appointed with magnificent precision that never changes or alters. Both the sun and the moon have distinct positions that they assume in summer and winter, effecting changes in the length of night and day. Allah said in other Ayat, 4b& 4> 4It is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the Moon as a light and measured out stages for it.} [10:5],

4 <3^—“ 4P* ^ ^ u5^i a-~-"* V^ 4/f is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit. [36:40], And, 4xv\ J— <\$T7ie sun and the moon; and the stars are subjected by His command.} [16:12] Allah's statement, i^Xi\ -j\$ s& \$>} iSuch is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} means, all of this occurs according to the decree and due measurement of the Almighty Who is never resisted or contradicted. He is the Knower of all things and nothing ever escapes His knowledge, not even the weight of an atom on earth or in heavens. Allah often mentions the

creation of the night, the day, the sun and the moon and then ends His Speech by mentioning His attributes of power and knowledge, as in this Ayah above [6:96], and in His statement. 4And a sign for them is the night, We' withdraw therefrom the day, and behold, they are in darkness. And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term . That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} [36:37-38] In the beginning of Surat Ha-Mim As-Sajdah, after mentioning the creation of the heavens and earth and all that is in them, Allah said: J^all J>£i liU'i U*4-J Cjif fcjj} 4And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps (stars) to be an adornment as well as to guard. Such is the decree ofHim, the Almighty, the All-Knower.} [41:12] Allah said next,

4It is He Who has set the stars for you, so that you may guide your course with their help through the darkness of the land and the sea.} Some of the Salaf said; Whoever believes in other than three things about these stars, then he has made a mistake, and lied against Allah. Indeed Allah made them as decorations for the heavens, and to shoot at the Shayatin, and for directions in the dark recesses of the land and sea. Then, Allah said, 4We have explained in detail Our Ayat.} meaning, We made them clear and plain, ifor people who know.} who have sound minds and are able to recognize the truth and avoid falsehood. #^2 /A <22 2 \$25'M ^ i^ 14^^ £C4 Ss& vj% 498. It is He Who has created you from a single person, and has given you a place of residing and a place ofstorage. Indeed, We have explained in detail Our revelations for people who understand.} 499. It is He Who sends down waterfrom the sky, and with it We bring forth vegetation of all kinds, and out of it We bring forth green stalks, from which We bring forth thick clustered grain. And out of the date-palm and its sprouts come forth clusters of dates hanging low and near, and gardens ofgrapes, olives and pomegranates, each similar, yet different. Look at their fruits when they begin to bear, and Yan'ih. Verily! In these things there are signsfor people who believe.} Allah said, 4)U5 oj« 3S 4It is He Who has created youfrom a single person,} (6:98)

in reference to Adam, peace be upon him. In another Ayah, Allah said; & £j5 ft 3K&J ii 4' jfe !\$ 40 mankind! Have Taqwa ofyour Lord, Wlw created you from a single person, and from him He created his mate, and from them both He created many men and women.^[4:1] Allah said, iMustaqar and Mustawda'} Ibn Mas*ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Abu 'Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Qays bin Abu Hazim, Mujahid, 'Ata', Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and others said that, 4Mustaqar}, "in the wombs'. They, or most of them, also said that, 4And Mustawda',} means, In your father's loins'. ' Ibn MasUd and several others said that, Mustaqar, means residence in this life, while, Mustawda', means the place of storage after death (the grave). Allah's statement, 4Indeed, We have explained in detail Our revelations for people who understand.} refers to those who comprehend and understand Allah's Words and its meanings. AllSh said next, 4It is He Who sends down water (rain)from the sky} m At-Tabari 11:565-570.

422 Tafstr Ibn Kathir in due measure, as a blessing and provision for the servants, relief and means of survival for the creatures and mercy from Allah for His creation. Allah's statement, iAttd with it We bringforth vegetation ofall kinds,} is similar to, iAnd We have madefrom water every living thing.} [21:30] iand out of it We bring forth green stalks,} green produce and trees, on whichWe grow seeds and fruits. ifrom which We bringforth thick clustered grain.} lined on top of each other in clusters, like an ear or spike of grain). iAnd out of the date-palm and its sprouts come forth clusters} of dates ihanging low} Within reach and easy to pick. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah Al-WaJibi said that Ibn 'Abbas said

that, clusters hanging low} refers to short date trees whose branches hang low, close to the ground. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ Allah's statement *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* means. We bring forth gardens of grapes. Grapes and dates are the most precious fruits to the people of Al-Hijaz (Western Arabia), and perhaps both are the best fruits in this world. Allah has reminded His servants of His *م* At-Tabari 11:576.

favor in making these two fruits for them, when He said, from the fruits of date-palms and grapes, you derive strong drink and a goodly provision.} [16:67] before intoxicating drinks were prohibited, and; *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* And We have made therein gardens of date-palms and grapes.} [36:34]. Allah said, *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* olives and pomegranates, each similar yet different.} The leaves are similar in shape and appearance, yet different in the shape, and taste. And the kind of fruit each plant produces is different, according to the explanation of Qatadah and several others. * Allah's statement, *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* Look at their fruits when they begin to bear, and *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* means, when the fruits become ripe, according to Al-Bara' bin 'Azib, Ibn 'Abbas, Ad-Dahhak, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi, Qatadah and others.*² This Ayah means, contemplate the ability of the Creator of these fruits, Who brought them into existence after they were dry wood, and they later became grapes and dates; and similar is the case with the various colors, shapes, tastes and fragrance of whatever Allah created. Allah said. *وَجَنَّاتٍ مِنْ دُونِهَا أَنْجَبُوا فِيهَا عَنْ لَأْسٍ مِنَ الشَّجَرِ وَهُمْ فِيهَا زَوْجٌّ وَفَرَسٌ خَلِيدٌ كَالْهَرَسِ* And in the earth are neighbouring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops, and date-palms, growing out, two or three from a single stem root, or otherwise, watered with the same water, yet some of them We make better than others to eat.} [13:4] ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 11 :578. * At-Tabari 11:582.

⁴²⁴ Tafsh Ibn Kathir This is why Allah said here, *لِنُفَصِّلَ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ* O people, signs...} and proofs that testify to the perfect ability, wisdom and mercy of He Who created these things, *لِنُفَصِّلَ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ* for people who believe.} in Allah and obey His Messengers. *لِنُفَصِّلَ الْآيَاتِ لِقَوْمٍ يَعْلَمُونَ* 14* A 4100. Yet, they join the Jinns as partners in worship with Allah, though He has created them, and they attribute, falsely without knowledge - sons and daughters to Him. Be He Glorified and Exalted above what that they attribute to Him.} Rebuking the Idolators This Ayah refutes the idolators who worshipped others besides Allah and associated the Jinns with Him in worship. Glory be to Allah above this Shirk and Kufr. If someone asks, how did the idolators worship the Jinns, although they only were idol worshippers? The answer is that in fact, they worshipped the idols by obeying the Jinns who commanded them to do so. Allah said in other Ayat, *وَالَّذِينَ يَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ دَعْوَهُمْ سَوَاءٌ مِمَّنْ دَعَبُوا* They invoke nothing but female deities besides Him, and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel! Allah cursed him. And he [Shaytan] said: "I will take an appointed portion of your servants. Verily, I will mislead them, and surely, I will arouse in them false desires; and certainly, I will order them to

⁴²⁵ Surah 6. Al-An'am (98 - 99) (Part-7) slit the ears of cattle, and indeed I will order them to change the nature created by Allah." And whoever takes Shaytan as a protector instead of Allah, has surely suffered a manifest loss. He [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} [4:117-120] and, *وَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا الْهَوَىَٰ فَيُضِلَّكُمْ سَبِيلَ اللَّهِ* Will you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than Me?} [18:50] Ibrahim said to his father, *يَا أَبَتِ لَا تَعْبُدِ الشَّيْطَانَ إِنَّهُ يَرِيعُ بَيْنَ الْإِنْسَانِ وَالْجَنِّ إِنَّ سَبِيلَهُ خِلَافٌ لِطَرِيقِ اللَّهِ إِنَّكَ وَمَنِ اتَّبَعْتَهُ لَكُمُ الْعَذَابُ وَسِيمٌ* my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily! Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Beneficent (Allah)" } [19:44] Allah said, *وَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا الْهَوَىَٰ فَيُضِلَّكُمْ سَبِيلَ اللَّهِ* Did I not ordain for you, O Children of Adam, that you

should not worship Shaytdn. Verily, he is a plain enemy to you. And that you should worship Me. That is a straight path.} [36:60-61] On the Day of Resurrection, the angels will proclaim. x'.» (r \?% j? |»+u> ot ^-b 4'Glorified be You! You are our Protector instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the jinn; most of them were believers in them.} [34:41] This is why Allah said here, }Yet, they join the Jinns as partners in worship with Allah, tlwugh He has created them.} [6:100], Alone without partners. Consequently, how is it that another deity is being worshipped along with Him? As Ibrahim said. u; &S tg&g C&& Si}

i"Worship you that which you (yourselves) carve? While Allah lias created you and what you make!"} [37:95-96] Allah alone is the Creatorwithout partners. Therefore, HeAlone deserves tobeworshipped without partners. Allah said next, 4fh jk 4And they Kharaqu (attribute falsely) without knowledge, sons and daughters to Him.} Allah mentions the misguidance of those who were led astray and claimed a son or offspring for Him, as the Jews did with TJzayr, the Christians with Isa and the Arab pagans with the angels whom they claimed were Allah's daughters. Allah is far holier than what the unjust, polytheist people associate with Him. The word, Kharaqu, means "falsely attributed, invented, claimed and lied", according to the scholars of the Salaf. Allah's statement next, 4&U. ££> £&£'} 4Be He Glorified and Exalted above (all) that they attribute to Him.} means, He is holier than, hallowed, and Exalted above the sons, rivals, equals and partners that these ignorant, misled people attribute to Him. ti' * ' V' ' cp? J5 i J2 js% %%& U ^Vf; tfcsn «®|S& 4101. He is the Bad? (Originator) of the heavens and the earth. How can He have children when He has no wife? He created all things and He is the All-Knower ofeverything.} Meaning ofBadV 4He is the Bad? of the heavens and the earth} Meaning He originated, created, invented and brought them into existence without precedence, as Mujahid and As-Suddi said. This is why the word for innovation - Bid'ah - comes AJ-Tabari 2 :540

Jr orn rn u ' from it, because it is something that did not have a precedence. \$& i; % %& S» ^J^yaj uSj f^j-J J^>- pel'll lljl j*'»-» |v»| ,JJJcJj a \jS aJ_)Oj/SfT ^jia^csfesSE^Jtsjjj<\$}og»yr sT'-O-jjK«L^i*yj i£vvl fiOllUjljia- •'«'.(' T v ,{<l if. > ' LajUUIJO ^v'-V^ f <, 'A'~ ^ jj- 1 s*y~iy. iHow can He have children when He has no wife?> for the child is the offspring of two compatible spouses. Allah does not have an equal, none of His creatures are similar to Him, for He alone created the entire creation. Allah said; ms \$ \$ & (SUfy Ju3 iAnd they say " The Most Beneficent (Allah) has begotten a son." Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing.> [19:88-89], until, iAnd everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .>[19:95]. iHe created all things and He is the All-Knower of everything.> He has created everything and He is All-Knower of all things. How can He have a wife from His creation who is suitable for His majesty, when there is none like Him? How can He have a

and Sunan collections. As for this life, MasrQq narrated that 'A'ishah said, "Whoever claims that Muhammad jg has seen his Lord, will have uttered a lie against Allah, for Allah the Most Honored, says, }No vision can grasp Him, but His grasp is over all vision.yW In the Sahih (Muslim) it is recorded that Abu Musa Al- Ash'ari narrated from the Prophet jg, 4-Jj J jl 4] 4)1 jj« 44.IS 'fi - jC3l j~ jllil « Verily, Allah does not sleep and it does not befit His majesty that He should sleep. He lowers the scale (of everything) and raises it. The deeds of the day are ascended to Him before the night, and the deeds of the night before the day. His Veil is the Light - or Fire - and if He removes it (the veil), the Light of His Face will bum every created thing that His sight reaches. » ,a| In the previous (revealed] Books

there is this statement, “When Musa requested to see Him, Allah said to Musa: ‘O Musa! Verily, no living thing sees Me, but it dies and no dried things sees me, but it rolls up.’ ” Allah said, 4So ivheti his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it collapse to dust, and Musa fill down unconscious. Then when he recovered his senses Ite said: "Glory be to You, I turn to You in repentance and I am the first of the believers."} [7 :143]. These Ayat, Hadiths and statements do not negate the fact ^ Fath Al-Bari 8 : 472 , Muslim 1: 159, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :441 , An- Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :335 , Muslim 6 : 49 121 Muslim 1 : 162.

mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Most Subtle, Well Acquainted} [31:16] tf t'j tys & sj XJ4 os ffo & (3ft *•' 4104. Verily, Basd'ir (proofs) have come to you from your Lord, so whosoever sees, will do so for (the good of) himself, and whosoever blinds himself, will do so against himself, and I am not a Hafiz over you.} 4105. Thus We explain variously the verses so that they (the disbelievers) may say: “You have Darasta (studied)” and that We may make the matter clear for the people who have knowledge.} The Meaning ofBasa'ir Basa'ir are the proofs and evidences in the Qur'an and the Message of Allah's Messenger jg. The Ayah, £>} 4so whosoever sees, will do so for (the good of) himself.} is similar J-s»i tfjii' £*} 4So whosoever receives guidance, he does so for the good of himself, and whosoever goes astray, he does so at his own loss.} [10:108] After Allah mentioned the Basd'ir, He said, <133 ce 4And whosoever blinds himself, will do so against himself,} meaning, he will only harm himself. Allah said, a\$ ^ <3 Q\$} 4Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} [22:46]

4And I (Muhammad) am not a Hafiz over you.} neither responsible, nor a watcher over you. Rather, I only convey, Allah guides whom He wills and misguides whom He wills. Allah said, 4^\$ 4Thus We explain variously the verses..>[6:105], meaning, just as We explained the Ay&t in this Surah, such as explaining Tawhid and that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah. This is how We explain the Ayat and make them plain and clear in all circumstances, to suffice the ignorance of the ignorant; and so that the idolaters and disbelievers who deny you say, ‘O Muhammad! You have Darasta with those who were before you from among the People of the Book and learned with them’. Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak said similarly.' ' At-Tabarani narrated that ‘Amr bin Kaysan said that he heard Ibn ‘Abbas saying, “Darasta, means, “recited, argued and debated.””12 ' This is similar to Allah's statement about the denial and rebellion of the disbelievers, LU» jStf jii pi <i!H "SI] Uci oj, &&&1^,1 £j\$!\ j&d biiij 4Those who disbelieve say, "Tltis (the Qur'an) is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him at it, so that they have produced an unjust wrong (thing) and a lie.” And they say, "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} [25:4-5] Allah described the chief liar of the disbelievers [Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah Al-Makhzumi], — ;* -I 'Sf -•? -.it -V.* ' V f yrf f f i&iM) >* Mr ' 45 "k "A 4 3 4Verily, he thought and plotted. So let him be cursed! How he plotted! And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! Then m At-Tabari 12:27. ' At-Tabarani 11 :137.

he thought. Then he frowned and he looked in a bad tempered way. Then he turned back and was proud. Tlten he said, "This is nothing but magic from that of old. This is nothing but the word ofa human being!"} [74:18-25] Allah said next, 4And that We may make the matter clear for the people who have

knowledge.} The Ayah means, so that We explain the matter to a people who know truth, and thus follow it, and know falsehood, and thus avoid it. Allah's wisdom is perfect, He allows the disbelievers to stray, and He guides the people who have knowledge. Allah said in other Ayat, 4By it He misleads many, and many He guides thereby.} [2:26], and; 4That He (Allah) may make what is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease and whose hearts are hardened.} [22:53] and, jkr*? 'S-*' o],)) 4And verily, Allah is the Guide of those who believe, to the straight path.} [22:54], iyjt jCil fJrAi fl*»- ly til*. Cj} 30 rrp 4 'cS && i*3 &. % hi &C ^ •i] Cj 'iLS & iS+r') '£» O' Sifi '.iV; 4»' j'jI ££ 4And We have set none but angels as guardians of the Fire, and We have fixed their number only as a trial for the disbelievers, in order that the People of the Scripture may arrive at a certainty and the believers may increase in faith, and that no doubts may be left for the People of the Scripture and the

believers, and that those in whose hearts is a disease (of hypocrisy) and the disbelievers may say, "What does Allah intend by this example?" Thus Allah leads astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills. And none can know the hosts of your Lord but He.) [74:3 1J, and; iAnd We send down in the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to the believers, and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.) [17:82], and, * *r •" * .i.i j*j jo 4 V ip: ^JUju ot iSay, "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away.") [41:44] There are similar Ayat that testify that Allah sent down the Qur'an as guidance to those who fear Him and that He guides or misguides whom He wills by the Qur'an. e# %%-gj.if#&& % m&i jJ z 4106. Follow what has been inspired (revealed) to you from your Lord, none has the right to be worshipped but He, and turn aside from the idolaters.) 4107. Had Allah willed, they would not have taken others besides Him in worship. And We have not made you Hafiz over them nor are you set over them to dispose of their affairs.) The Command to Follow the Revelation Allah commands His Messenger and those who followed his path, 4Follow what has been inspired to you from your Lord,) meaning, follow it, obey it and act according to it. What has been revealed to you from your Lord is the Truth, no doubt,

and there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, io&ZK J^j} iand him aside from the idolaters} meaning, forgive them, be forbearing and endure their harm until Allah brings relief to you, supports you and makes you triumphant over them. Know - O Muhammad jg - that there is a wisdom behind misleading the idolaters, and that had Allah willed, He would have directed all people to guidance, (\&\ Z& XL %} iHad Allah willed, they would not have taken others besides Him in worship.} Allah's is the perfect will and wisdom in all decrees and decisions, and He is never questioned about what He does, while they all will be questioned. Allah's statement, 4And We have not made you Hafiz over them.} means, a watcher who observes their statements and deeds, \tj} iNor are you set over them to dispose of their affairs.} or to control their provision. Rather, your only job is to convey, just as Allah said, iSo remind them, you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.} (88:21-22] and, iVdS gjf Cj} iYour duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} (13:40) ii,\ j£j iSj fia j«u at a! oJ» & oy- r&A r& 4108. And insult not those whom they worship besides Allah, lest they insult Allah wrongfully without knowledge. Thus We have made fair seeming to each people its own doings; then to their Lord is their return and He shall inform them of all that they used to do.}

The Prohibition of Insulting the False gods of the Disbelievers, So that they Do not Insult Allah Allah prohibits His Messenger and the believers from insulting the false deities of the idolaters, although there is a clear benefit in doing so. Insulting their deities will lead to a bigger evil than its benefit, for the idolaters might retaliate by insulting the God of the believers, Allah, none has the right to be worshipped but He. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on this Ayah [6:108]; “They (disbelievers) said, ‘O Muhammad! You will stop insulting our gods, or we will insult your Lord.’ Thereafter, Allah prohibited the believers from insulting the disbelievers’ idols, lest they insult Allah wrongfully without knowledge. ‘Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma’mar said that Qatadah said, Muslims used to insult the idols of the disbelievers and the disbelievers would retaliate by insulting Allah wrongfully without knowledge. Allah revealed, — And insult not those whom they worship besides Allah. On this same subject - abandoning what carries benefit to avert a greater evil - it is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah said, “Cursed is he who insults his own parents» They said, “O Allah’s Messenger! And how would a man insult his own parents?” He said, «He insults a man's father, and that man insults his father, and insults his mother and that man insults his mother. In Allah’s statement, & {Thus We have made fair seeming to each people its own doings;} means, as We made fair seeming to the idolaters loving their idols and defending them, likewise We made fair seeming to every previous nation the misguidance they indulged in. Allah’s is the most perfect proof, and the most complete wisdom in all that He wills and chooses. (*E-> it then to their Lord is their return,) gathering and final destination, and He shall then inform them of all that they used to do.} He will compensate them for their deeds, good for good and evil for evil. Uj jcc cJffi ji • pfe 05? 'x**r fh) iX p'A i&> o;t 6l 4109. And they swear their strongest oaths by Allah, that if there came to them a sign, they would surely believe therein. Say: "Signs are but with Allah and what will make you perceive that (even) if it came, they will not believe?"} 4110. And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe therein for the first time, and We shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly.} Asking for Miracles and Swearing to Believe if They Come Allah states that the idolaters swore their strongest oaths by Allah, 111 Fath Al-Bari 10:417.

«He insults a man's father, and that man insults his father, and insults his mother and that man insults his mother. In Allah’s statement, & {Thus We have made fair seeming to each people its own doings;} means, as We made fair seeming to the idolaters loving their idols and defending them, likewise We made fair seeming to every previous nation the misguidance they indulged in. Allah’s is the most perfect proof, and the most complete wisdom in all that He wills and chooses. (*E-> it then to their Lord is their return,) gathering and final destination, and He shall then inform them of all that they used to do.} He will compensate them for their deeds, good for good and evil for evil. Uj jcc cJffi ji • pfe 05? 'x**r fh) iX p'A i&> o;t 6l 4109. And they swear their strongest oaths by Allah, that if there came to them a sign, they would surely believe therein. Say: "Signs are but with Allah and what will make you perceive that (even) if it came, they will not believe?"} 4110. And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe therein for the first time, and We shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly.} Asking for Miracles and Swearing to Believe if They Come Allah states that the idolaters swore their strongest oaths by Allah, 111 Fath Al-Bari 10:417.

438 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4that if there came to them a sign...} a miracle or phenomenon. 4they would surely believe therein.} affirming its truth, 4% i* Ci \$} 4Say: ",Signs are but with Allah."} [6:109] meaning: Say, O Muhammad si - to those who ask you for signs out of defiance, disbelief and rebellion, not out of the desire for guidance and knowledge - “The matter of sending signs is for Allah. If He wills, He sends them to you, and if He wills, He ignores your request.” Allah said next, 4U& V lil t# 4And what will make you perceive that (even) if it came, they will not believe?} It was said that ‘you’ in ‘make you perceive’ refers to the idolaters, according to Muj&hid. In this case, the Ayah would mean, what makes you - you idolaters - perceive that you are truthful in the vows that you swore? Therefore, in this recitation, the Ayah means, the idolaters will still not believe if the sign that they asked for came. It was also said that ‘you’ in, ‘what will make you perceive’, refers to the believers, meaning, what will make you perceive, O believers, that the idolaters will still not believe if the signs come. Allah also said, iSS& h*3 4"What prevented you (O Iblts) that you did not prostrate, when I commanded you?"} [7:12] and, 4And a ban is laid on every town (population) which We have destroyed that they shall not

return (to this world again).} [21:95] These Ayat mean: What made you, O Iblls, refrain from prostrating, although I commanded you to do so, and, in the

second Ayah, that village shall not return to this world again. In the Ayah above [6:109], the meaning thus becomes: What makes you perceive, O believers, who wish eagerly for the disbelievers to believe, that if the Ayat came to them they would believe? Allah said next, ffl .«as -i* p'4 {And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe thereinfor the first time,} Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah, "When the idolaters rejected what Allah sent down, their hearts did not settle on any one thing and they turned away from every matter (of benefit)." 1 11 Mujahid said that Allah's statement, p'4 {andWe shall turn their hearts and their eyes away,} means, We prevent them from the faith, and even if every sign came to them, they will not believe, just as We prevented them from faith the first time. Similar was said by 'Ikrimah and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah mentions what the servants will say before they say it and what they will do before they do it. Allah said; & JSg vj» {And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} [35:14] and, {\$ sj&r 4 c-1it £ 4^ {Lest a person should say, "Alas, my grief that I was undutifal to Allah."} [39:56] until, Oi 4^3 3b {"Ifonly I had another chance, then I should indeed be among the doers ofgood."} [39:58]. So Allah, glory be to Him, states that if they were sent back A{-Tabari 12:44.

to life, they would not accept the guidance, l)r Q }But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbid- den. And indeed they are liars.} (6:28] Allah said, IT P'A 4.}v* <3}f 2 iAnd We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from gui- dance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time,} meaning: If they were sent back to this life, they would be prevented from embracing the guidance, just as We prevented them from it the first time, when they were in the life of this world."111 Allah said, iand We shall leave them...} and abandon them, m mm % or.t . 1 , - > > - * * Aff 'fS iin their trespass...} meaning, disbelief, according to Ibn 'Abbas and As-Suddi. Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and Qatadah said that 'their trespass' means, "their misguidance'. m At-Tabari 12 :45

441Surah 6. Al-An'dm (111) (Part-8) 4to wander blindly or playfully, according to Al-A'mash. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabi', Abu Malik and others commented, "to wander in their disbelief." IjIT til & \$ fig £3 uy 0 %m 4111. And even ifWe had sent dawn unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before them, they would not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most ofthem behave ignorantly.} Allah says: 'Had We accepted what the disbelievers asked for,' that is - those who swore their strongest oaths by Allah that if a miracle came to them they would believe in it - 'had We sent down angels,' to convey to them Allah's Message, in order to support the truth of the Messengers, as they asked, when they said, i'iS &\$ f} 4or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face.} [17:92] 4They said: "We shall not believe until we receive the like of that which the Messengers of Allah had received."} [6:124] and, Ail f i'. yp b«UJ y Jlij 4And those who expect not a meeting with Us said : "Winy are not the angels setit down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride.} [25:21] Allah said. iand the dead had spoken unto them,} This is, to inform them of the truth of what the Messengers brought them;

they may remain pleased with it, and that they may commit what they are committing . Every Prophet Has Enemies Allah says, just as We made enemies for you, O Muhammad, who will oppose and rebel against you and become your adversaries, We also made enemies for every Prophet who came before you. Therefore, do not be saddened by this fact. Allah said in other Ayat. itik c# i&s# 345 sip {Verily, Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt...} [6:34], and, JiJ j[/*** jj! ii£>J tiUr* 02 Jji Ji L»^ till Jli) {Nothing is said to you except what was said to the Messengers before you. Verily, your Lord is the Possessor offorgiveness, and (also) the Possessor ofpainful punishment.) [41:43] and, {Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.) [25:31]. Waraqah bin Nawfal said to Allah's Messenger jg, "None came with what you came with but he was the subject of enmity." Allah's statement, {Shayatin among mankind...} refers to, {enemies...} meaning, the Prophets have enemies among the devils of mankind and the devils of the Jinns. The word, Shaytan, describes one who is dissimilar to his kind due to his or her wickedness. Indeed, only the Shaydfin, may Allah humiliate and curse them, from among mankind and the Jinns oppose the Messengers. 'Abdur-Razzaq said that Ma'mar Al-Bukhari no : 3

narrated that Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, iShayattn (decoils) among mankind and Jinn...} "There are devils among the Jinns and devils among mankind who inspire each other." Allah's statement, Jj of" (3) (*+>"" dfjfi 4inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion .} means, they inspire each other with beautified, adorned speech that deceives the ignorant who hear it, c4 as ilfyour Lord had so willed, they would not have done it;} for all this occurs by Allah's decree, will and decision, that every Prophet had enemies from these devils, ->-<rxUj pijJif iso leave them alone with theirfabrications.} and lies. This Ayah orders patience in the face of the harm of the wicked and to trust in Allah against their enmity, for, "Allah shall suffice for you (O Muhammad) and aid you against them." Allah's statement, iAnd Tasghd to it.} means, according to Ibn 'Abbas, "incline to it." 4the hearts of those who do not believe in the Hereafter...} their hearts, mind and hearing. As-Suddi said that this Ayah refers to the hearts of the disbelievers.*2 4And that they may remain pleased with it.} At-Tabari 12 :58 At-Tabari 12:59

they like and adore it. Only those who disbelieve in the Hereafter accept this evil speech, being enemies of the Prophets, etc., just as Allah said in other Ayat, 4'ik#& JC 4So, verily, you (pagans) and those whom you worship (idols). Cannot lead astray. Except those who are predestined to bum in Hell!) [37:161-163] and, 4Certainhr-yourhave different ideas. Turned aside therefrom is he lohcrfs turned aside.) [51:8-9] — Allah said; 4^L>}}j£ pi £ lyjlj) 4And that they may commit what they are committing.) meaning, "let them earn whatever they will earn", according to 'Ali bin Abi Tajhah who reported this from Ibn 'Abbas.1,1 As- Suddi and . Ibn Zayd also commented, "Let them do whatever they will do." ,2' iifj \$ 'J&\) \$^ 4 » 32 0&& c&l 43@aiCJf LJti ^ (jjl. 4114. [Say:] "Shall I seek a judge other than Allah while it is He Who has sent down unto you the Book, explained in detail." Those unto whom We gave the Scripture know that it is revealed from your Lord in truth. So be not you of those who doubt.) 4115. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice. None can change His Words. And He is the All- Hearer, the All-Knower.) Allah tells His Prophet jg to say to these polytheists who worship others besides Allah, m At-Tabari 12 :59 121 At-Tabari 12 :60

40S. u0\$ 4Shall I seek a judge other than Allah ...^ between you and I, iwhile it is He Who has sent down unto you the Book, —explained...}m detail iand those unto whom We gave the Scripture£ the Jews and the Christians, 0* Jj**^ iknow that it is revealedfrom your Lord in truth.} because the previous Prophets have conveyed the good news of you coining to them. Allah’s statement, UUP 4So be not you of those who doubt .^ is similar to His other statement, A&r3 ot 4^=0? 4>vi» 0^ 4(\$SiS&slf^UP# 4So j/you are in doubt concerning that which We have revealed unto you, then ask those who are reading the Book before you. Verily, die truth has come to you from your Lord. So be not of those who doubt (it).} [10:94) The conditional “if in this Ayah does not mean that ‘doubt’ will ever occur to the Prophet gg . Allah said, 4fej iLf%^ £%} 4And the Word ofyour Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice.} Qatadah commented, “In truth concerning what He stated and in justice concerning what He decided.” 1 11 Surely, whatever Allah says is the truth and He is Most Just in what m At-Tabari 12:63

He commands. All of Allah’s statements are true, there is no doubt or cause for speculation about this fact, and all His commandments are pure justice, besides which there is no justice. All that He forbade is evil, for He only forbids what brings about evil consequences. Allah said in another Ayah, 4£sa±& ^ ft 4He commands them with good; and forbids them from evil...} [7:157] until the end of the Ayah. 4None can change His Words.} meaning, none can avert Allah’s judgment whether in this life or the Hereafter, iy& 4And He is the All-Hearer,} Hearing, His servants’ statements, 4^ 1} 4The All-Knower.} of their activities and lack of activity. Who awards each according to their deeds. (** (ijj i)y*& if 4A-SK if if J* <4j "3} 4116. And if you obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far away from Allah’s path. They follow nothing but conjecture, and they do nothing but lie.} 4117. Verily, your Lord! It is He Who knows best who strays from His way, and He knows best the rightly guided.} Most People are Misguided Allah states that most of the people of the earth, are misguided. Allah said in other Ayat, 4mp m 4And indeed most of the men of old went astray before them.} 137:711 and, 4w^k K’j} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you eagerly desire >(.^[12:103]

tissam uEH'fia '^=| They are misguided, @4*r >r - f^O^—^C jj 16iT4jJab_J I 'i£j£\ ^Li^Jtl^2j ojj^T*) Ojil bL<>-vilJ.'^5 ^ ^jjJL--<j \j>IS"t 0* JtS" ,>• jiicl yk^ iX^ ^/f is He Who knows best who straysfrom His way.\$ and facilitates that for him, P 'i> iAnd He knows best the rightly guided.> He facilitates that for them, all ofthem are facilitated for what He created them. lii \j&Jz vt j\$3 Cj p* o\ 4& \ ij\sh)> 1*^ ojj *Jj ^jjLi>\ c vi j^2c^ (5 jj3 J5J fix fix '£i P J* -Xxj 81 j*> ^+AyX ||| \’ojjP=X \x\ 1 -zf '-' 3 AUI^JllJ —ij i_j_} \ y£y *Jr><jU \£A yet they have doubts about their way, and they rely on wishful thinking and delusions. £#W vi oAX;& 4They follow nothing but conjecture, and they do nothing but lie Thus, they fulfill Allah’s decree and decision concerning them. 4118. So eat of that on which Allah's Name has been mentioned, ifyou are believers in His Aydt.\$ 4119. And why should you not eat of that on which Allah’s Name has been mentioned, while He has explained to you in detail what is forbidden to you, except under compulsion of necessity? And surely, many do lead astray by their own desires through lack of knowledge. Certainly your Lord knows

best the transgressors.} AllowingWhatwas Slaughtered in the Name ofAllah This is a statement of permission from Allah, for His servants, allowing them to eat the slaughtered animals wherein His Name was mentioned when slaughtering them. It is understood from it that He has not allowed that over

which Allah's Name was not mentioned when slaughtering. This was the practice of the pagans of Quraysh who used to eat dead animals and eat what was slaughtered for the idols. Allah next encourages eating from the meat of sacrificed animals on which His Name was mentioned upon slaughtering, 'p tf p& JaJ&\$ -1 yi \L. yfp iAnd why should you not eat of that on which Allah's Name has been mentioned, while He has explained to you what is forbidden to you ...} meaning, He has explained and made clear to you what He has prohibited for you in detail, 3^1 C iexcept under compulsion of necessity.} In which case, you are allowed to eat whatever you can find. Allah next mentions the ignorance of the idolators in their misguided ideas, such as eating dead animals and what was sacrificed while other than Allah's Name was mentioned when slaughtering them. Allah said, J* £i) oj-i off} iAnd surely, many do lead astray by their own desires through lack of knowledge. Certainly your Lord knows best the transgressors.} He has complete knowledge of their transgression, lies and inventions. 'j'y 5jl_s2 4220. Leave sin, open and secret. Verily, those who commit sin will get due recompense for that which they used to commit.}

Mujahid said that, b^>j} iLeave evil, open and secret...} refers to all kinds of sins committed in public and secret.' Qatadah said that, iLeave sin, open and secret. . .} encompasses sins committed in public and secret, whether few or many.'2 ' In another statement, Allah said, 4Say : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (evil sins) whether committed openly or secretly.} [7:33J This is why Allah said, ^jyjUj \ylt IL oyrP iVerily, those who commit sin will get due recompense for that which they used to commit.} Whether the sins they committed were public or secret, Allah will compensate them for these sins. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that An-Nawwas bin Sam'an said, "I asked Allah's Messenger jg about Al-Ithm. He said, ,>&i if iijl> j?lJu- u *The sin is that which you find in your heart and you dislike that people become aware of if.*13' JLjtljlf *.N *& \$ i-t JS ^ iL Yj} 4121. Eat not of that on which Allah's Name has not been pronounced, for surely it is disobedience. And certainly, the Shayatin do inspire their friends to dispute with you, and if you 1,1 At-Tabari 12:73 121 At-Tabari 12 :72 131 Muslim 4 :1980

451 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (121) (Part-8) obey them, then you would indeed be polytheists.) The Prohibition of what was Slaughtered in other Allah's Name This Ayah is used to prove that slaughtered animals are not lawful when Allah's Name is not mentioned over them - even if slaughtered by a Muslim. The Ayah about hunting game, jsP pz \ 1&) 4So eat of what they (trained hunting dogs or birds of prey) catch for you, but pronounce the Name of Allah over it.) [5:4] supports this. The Ayah here emphasized this ruling, when Allah said, £0 ifar surely it is disobedience.) They say that "it" refers to eating it, and others say that it refers to the sacrifice for other than Allah. There are various Hadiths that order mentioning Allah's Name when slaughtering and hunting. The Hadith narrated by 'Adi bin Hatim and Abu Thalabah (that the Prophet jg said); iL-il u riU 4>i pi o& jjfcji iris ^Lj\ isi 'When you send your trained hunting dog and mention Allah's Name on releasing it, then eat from whatever it catches far yoM.» This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahths. Khadlj narrated that the Prophet jg said; rip 4>i pi y>lj fo)j y\$\ u» The Rafi' bin 'You can use what would make bloodflow (i.e., slaughter) and you can eat what is slaughtered and the Name of Allah is mentioned at the time of slaughtering. This Hadith was also collected in the Two SahOis)2 ^ Ibn Mas* Ckd narrated that Allah's Messenger said to the Jinns. 'dz 4.1 pi y£pt js Fath Al-Bari 9 :524 and 9 :137 and Muslim 3 :1529 and 3 :1532 Fath Al-Bari 9 :546 and Muslim 3 :1558

a(For food) you have every bone on which Allah's Name was mentioned on slaughtering .» Muslim collected this Hadith} 1] Jundub bin Sufyan Al-Bajali said that the Messenger Allah said, if it were that a man slaughtered before he prayed (the 'id prayer), let him slaughter another sacrifice in its place. Whoever did not offer the sacrifice before we finished the prayer, let him slaughter and mention Allah's Name . » The Two Sahihs recorded this Hadith. [2] The Devil's Inspiration Allah said, and certainly, the Shaytān do inspire their friends to dispute with you,} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ishaq said that a man said to Ibn 'Umar that Al-Mukhtar claimed that he received revelation. So Ibn 'Umar said, "He has said the truth," and recited this Ayah, and certainly, the Shaytān do inspire their friends...» Abu Zam'ala said, "I was sitting next to Ibn 'Abbas at a time when Al-Mukhtar bin Abi Talbah was performing Hajj. So a man came to Ibn 'Abbas and said, 'O Ibn 'Abbas! Abu Ishaq (Al-Mukhtar) claimed that he received revelation this night.' Ibn 'Abbas said, 'He has said the truth.' I was upset and said, 'Ibn 'Abbas says that Al-Mukhtar has said the truth?' Ibn 'Abbas replied, 'There are two types of revelation, one from Allah, Muslim 1 :332 ' FathAl-Bari 9 :546 and Muslim 3 :1551 131 Ibn Abi Hatim 4:1379

Allah and one from the devil. Allah's revelation came to Muhammad (ﷺ), while the Shaytan's revelation comes to his friends.' He then recited, and certainly, the Shaytān do inspire their friends... We also mentioned 'Ikrimah's commentary on the Ayah, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion.} Allah said next, and to dispute with you,} Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented; %} Eat not of that on which Allah's Name has not been mentioned. . .} until, 4-. -to dispute with you,} "The devils inspire their loyal supporters, so you eat from what you kill but not from what Allah causes to die?"*21 As-Suddi said; "Some idolators said to the Muslims, 'You claim that you seek Allah's pleasure. Yet, you do not eat what Allah causes to die, but you eat what you slaughter?' Allah said, and if you obey them...}, and eat dead animals, then you would indeed be polytheists.}13 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-pahhak and several others in At-Tabari 12:86 At-Tabari 12:81 [3] At-Tabari 12:81

among scholars of the Salaf Giving Preference to Anyone's Saying Over the Legislation of Allah is Shirk Allah's statement, and if you obey them, then you would indeed be polytheists.} means, when you turn away from Allah's command and Legislation to the saying of anyone else, preferring other than what Allah has said, then this constitutes Shirk. Allah said in another Ayah, 4\$ Oi lJXC& } iThey (Jews and Christians) took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah,}[9:31] In explanation of this Ayah, At-Tirmidhi recorded that 'Adi bin Hatim said, "O Allah's Messenger! They did not worship them." The Prophet (ﷺ) said, J&Jl \yfr-o f&l ,Je «Yes they did. They (monks and rabbis) allowed the impermissible for them and they prohibited the lawful for them, and they followed them in that. That was their worship of them.*12 ' C~jSiS\ 4 yiii ifrZ _} is?*i /I LIU».J .lffa ELli jfc" jZ f} 4^^>X^i l>£> {yl% J-? 4122. Is he who was dead, and We gave him life, and set for him a light, whereby he can walk among men - like him who is in the darkness from which he can never come out? Thus it is made fair seeming to the disbelievers that which they used to do.} At-Tabari 12:80 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :492

The Parable of the Disbeliever and the Believer This is an example that Allah has given of the believer who was dead, meaning, wandering in confusion and misguidance. Then, Allah brought life to him, by

bringing life to his heart with faith, guiding him to it and guiding him to obeying His Messengers, and set for him a light whereby he can walk amongst men. > for he became guided to where he should go and how to remain on the correct path. The light mentioned here is the Qur'an, according to Ibn 'Abbas, as Al-'Awfi and Ibn Abi Talhah reported from him.¹¹¹ As-Suddi said that the light mentioned here is Islam.¹² Both meanings are correct. Like him who is in the darkness of ignorance, desires and various types of deviation, from which he can never come out? for he is unable to find a way out from what he is in. In Musnad Ahmad, it is recorded that the Prophet ﷺ said: *«Luj iojjj ^ja ^ qAg ^ 4ti jj»*. (Allah created creation in darkness, then He showered His Light upon them. Whoever was struck by that light is guided, whoever it missed is astray. »³ Allah said in other Ayat, *ttssr Si % At-Tabari 12:91. At-Tabari 12:91. 131 Ahmad 2:176*

Vi IS ^ £ 4 (dEl^ Jjly "C j-4 jjS ££ Sii^ J iiC jiJjTX \S ^jSj M lx.to i&JJI q;it .1^ ££ 11 £2^ 'y^ 1 4123. And thus We have set up in every town great ones of its wicked people to plot therein. But they plot not except against themselves, and they perceive (it) not.} 4124. And when there comes to them a sign they say: "We shall not believe until we receive the like of that which the Messengers of Allah received." Allah knows best with whom to entrust His Message. Humiliation and disgrace from Allah and a severe torment will overtake the criminals for that which they used to plot.} Evil Plots of the Leaders of the Criminals and their Subsequent Demise Allah says: Just as We appointed chiefs and leaders for the criminals who call to disbelief, hinder from the path of Allah, and oppose and defy you in your town, O Muhammad. Such was also the case with the Messengers before you, who were tested with the same. But the good end was always theirs.' Allah said in other Ayat, *iThus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.* [25:31] Allah said, *4vJj i C? tjyi r^»*} 4And when We decide to destroy a town, We send a definite order to those among them who lead a life of luxury, and they transgress therein.} [17:16] meaning, We command them to obey Us, but they defy the command and as a consequence, We destroy them. It was also said that, "We send a definite order", in the last Ayah means, "We decree for them," as Allah stated here

to plot therein.} Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas explained the Ayah *jt££=^} < . .* .great ones of its wicked people to plot therein.} "We give the leadership to these wicked ones and they commit evil in it. When they do this, We destroy them with Our torment." Mujahid and Qatadah said that in the Ayah, *%kJ} igreat ones* refers to leaders.' I say that this is also the meaning of Allah's statements, *L<j G[JB V) _/ij J* ijji £ bju^l ^j}* 4And We did not send a Warner to a township, but those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among them, said: "We believe not in what you have been sent with." And they say : "We have too much wealth and too many children and we are not going to suffer punishment."} [34:34-35] And, *tyj jJ* Gitjli til*-j UjtA* JB jjij j ji CtjJ Xa tXU:Sf}* and similarly. We sent not a Warner before you to any town but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeed follow their footsteps."} [43:23] 'Plot' in the Ayah [6:123] refers to beautified speech and various actions with which the evil ones call to misguidance. Allah said about the people of Prophet Nuh, peace be upon him, *I1* ' At-Tabari 12:94.

f/iey /woe plotted a mighty plot. (71:22 (Allah said, *Jy-J Jj^' w'jfV p 4 •*».*' |*£J J-i*; >* S/ i^SL:(iir j* S3 jJ* i£?Sif *Jj i^T jS jlij 5 jfc H II ^ \$ 54^ i) j4j iv^ <3 bvi a J<&\$ 1Z s 1&& uk ^Buf »/ you could see when the wrongdoers will be made to stand before their Lord, how they will cast the (blaming)

word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers." And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: ",Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were criminals." Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivalsfor Him!"} (34:31-33). Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Ibn Abi 'Umar said that Sufyan said, "Every "plot" mentioned in the Qur'an refers to actions." Allah's statement, iBut they plot not except against themselves, and they perceive (it) not.} means, the harm of their wicked plots, as well as misguiding those whom they lead astray, will only strike them. Allah said in other Ay&t, iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.} (29:13) and, Juu Jiji}

461Surali 6. Al-An'dm (123 - 124) (Part-8) transgression, rebellion and defiance. Allah described them, 4.W; tfjli UiJ !j>_a 4>'j tojjy 4Aw/ ry/ien they see you, they only mock: "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger?"} [25:41] and j&l*1 1* —s'& !i>» V[Jkjijji' L£^=* j-J' |*j> (>-*j 4A«d when those who disbelieved see you, they only mock at you : "Is this the one who talks about your gods?" While they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious (Allah).} [21:36], and, [tisfa'" i^u 4Indeed Messengers were mocked before, but the scoffers were surrounded by that, whereat they used to mock.} [21:41] The Disbelievers Admit to the Prophet's Nobility of Lineage The disbelievers did all of this although they admitted to the Prophet's virtue, honorable lineage, respectable ancestry and purity of household and upbringing, may Allah, His angels, and the believers send blessings upon him. The disbelievers used to call the Prophet j||, before he received revelation, 'Al- Amin' - the Truthful. The leader of the Quraysh disbelievers, Abu Sufyan, had to admit to this fact when Heraclius, emperor of Rome, asked him, "How honorable is his (the Prophet's) ancestral lineage among you?" Abu Sufyan answered, "His ancestry is highly regarded among us." Heraclius asked, "Do you find that he lied, before he started his mission?" Abu Sufyan replied, "No." The emperor of Rome relied on the honor and purity of the Prophet jg to recognize the truth of his prophethood and what he came with. Imam Ahmad recorded that Wathilah bin Al-Asqa' said that the Messenger of Allah Hg said, J>. jt & ji i aiw 0 0 ^ I O P ** J *0 cffi Cs! <*-?!* l*?! Lriy Irf lfo***\j lt! CrJ l- - ' - ili

Hi OigDgtt 4And your Lord treats no one with injustice} [18:49] Allah said in another Ayah, 40%*\$0 4Jhe Day when all the secrets will be examined.} [86:9] Meaning, the secrets, hidden thoughts and intentions will be exposed. In the Two SahVis, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jlip t si> :JLu iyiJl I I j? 0*A» j? 'j- iA banner will be raised for every deceitful person from his anus on the Day.of Resurrection, and it will say; 'This is the treacherous plot of so-and-so, son ofso-and-so, son ofso-and-so.,n*1 The wisdom in this is that since a plot occurs in secret, and people are usually unaware of it, then on the Day of Resurrection the plot itself will become public news testifying to the actions of those who committed it. ill oij f&ilV& Gr* teMi \$ if &. fcáf 4 &£ Qfe-* Cf 4125. And whomsoever Allah wills to guide. He opens his t)£Sm , > -f/v "I" - 4jj^>6'4»i 3>\$ I4I41I} 111 FathAl-B&ri6:327 and Muslim 4 :1361

breast to Islam; and whomsoever He wills to send astray, He makes his breast closed and constricted, as ifhe is climbing up to the sky. Thus Allah puts the wrath on those who believe not.} Allah said, 4And whomsoever Allah wills to guide. He opens his breast to Islam;} He makes Islam easy for him and

^because of what they used to do,} As reward for their good deeds, Allah has favored them and been generous with them, and awarded them Paradise. as; S5 ij&a ig^ && C -Ji ty 3s &£p4 up T2&^ ii\$- icj Si& its 4128. And on the Day when He will gather them together (and say): "O you assembly of Jinn! Many did you mislead of men," and their friends among the people will say: "Our Lord! We benefited one from the other, but now we have reached our appointed term which You did appoint for us." He will say: "The Fire be your dwelling place, you will dwell therein forever, except as Allah may will. Certainly your Lord is All- Wise, All-Knowing."} Allah says, 'Mention, O Muhammad, in what you convey and warn,' that, && }>}} ion the Day when He will gather them (all) together.} gather the Jinns and their loyal supporters from mankind who used to worship them in this life, seek refuge with them, obey them and inspire each other with adorned, deceitful speech. Allah will proclaim then. iO you assembly of Jinn! Many did you mislead of men,} So the Ayah; iMany did you mislead of men} refers to their misguiding and leading them astray. Allah also said; Jj J3 &\ Z&3\ \)Zc 'J JI p: jff \$t} lyj** |*0 JjvjT jP j&j '£ iDid I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you

468 Tafstr Ibn Kathir should not worship Shaytan. Verily, he is a plain enemy to you. And that you should worship Me. That is the straight path . And indeed he (Shaytan) did lead astray a great multitude of you. Did you not, then, understand?) [36:60-62], and iand their friends among the people will say: "Our Lord! We benefited one from the other . . .") The friends of the Jinns among humanity will give this answer to Allah, after Allah chastises them for being misguided by the Jinns. Al-Hasan commented, "They benefited from each other when the Jinns merely commanded and mankind obeyed." Ibn Jurayj said, "During the time of Jahiliyyah, a man would reach a land and proclaim, 'I seek refuge with the master (Jinn) of this valley,' and this is how they benefited from each other. They used this as an excuse for them on the Day of Resurrection."*2 * Therefore, the Jinns benefit from humans since humans revere the Jinns by invoking them for help. The Jinns would then proclaim, "We became the masters of both mankind and the Jinns." ifo tfj' tp ibut now we have reached our appointed term which You did appoint for us.) meaning, death, according to As-Suddi. 'jQ\ Si) 4He (Allah) will say : "The Fire be your dwelling place..." where you will reside and live, you and your friends, 4you will dwell therein forever.) and will never depart except what Allah may will. ^ Jjs i Hj Um) Jvo llyjSj) Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3 :357 Al-Tabari 12:116

469 Surah 6. Al-An'am (129 - 130) (Part-8) 4129. And thus We do make the wrongdoers supporters of one another, because of that which they used to earn.} The Wrongdoers Are the Supporters of Each other Ma'mar said that Qatadah commented on this Ayah, "Allah makes the wrongdoers supporters for each other in the Fire by following one another into it." 111 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah's statement, 4And thus We do make the wrongdoers supporters of one another.> "It refers to the wrongdoers of the Jinns and mankind."*21 He then recited, f'-.t y ' > • ' "X. 4And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious (Allah), We appoint for him Shaytan to be a companion to him>[43:36] He said next - concerning the meaning of the Ayah; "We appoint the wrongdoer of the Jinns over the wrongdoer of mankind." A poet once said, "There is no hand, but Allah's Hand is above it, and no wrongdoer but will be tested by another wrongdoer."

The meaning of this honorable Ayah thus becomes: ‘Just as

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1791–1809]

We made this losing group of mankind supporters of the Jinns that misguided them, We also appoint the wrongdoers over one another, destroy them by the hands of one another, and take revenge from them with one another. This is the just recompense for their injustice and transgression.’ *21 \yfr .lipl J jje 'jjLjj Gjj ;il ijlu ijc 4130. O you assembly of Jinn and humans! “Did not there * 1 ’ ‘Abdur-Razzaq 2:218 121 At-Tabari 12:119

come to you Messengers from amongst you, reciting unto you My verses and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?” They will say: “We bear witness against ourselves.” It was the life of this world that deceived them. And they will bear witness against themselves that they were disbelievers.} Chastising the Jinns and Humans after their Admission that Allah Sent Messengers to Them Allah will chastise the disbelieving Jinns and humans on the Day of Resurrection, when He asks them, while having better knowledge, if the Messengers delivered His Messages to them, i”0 you assembly of Jinn and humans! Did not there come to you Messengers from among you?”} We should note here that the Messengers are from among mankind only, not vice versa, as Mujahid, Ibn Jurayj and others from the Imams of Salaf and later generations have stated. ’ The proof for this is that Allah said, is trA& iVerily, We have sent the revelation to you as We sent the revelation to Nuh and the Prophets after him.} [4:163], until, < Jk k ^Messengers as bearers of good news as well as of warning in order that mankind should have no plea against Allah after the (coming of) Messengers.} [4:165] Allah said, concerning the Prophet Ibrahim, iAnd We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book} [29:27], thus sending the prophethood and the Book exclusively through the offspring of the Prophet Ibrahim. No one has m Af-Tabari 12:122

471 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (129 - 130) (Part-8) claimed that there were Prophets from among the Jiiuis before the time of Ibrahim, but not after that. Allah said, 4 S'l 2££If Ss^ iXji 4-And We newer sent before you any o/ the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets [25:20], and, & U iAnd We sent not before you any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships.} [12:109] Therefore, concerning prophethood, the Jirms follow mankind in this regard and this is why Allah said about them, (g+t AA Qli 111* 0^' Oi <^1 tijv. CjJj C5 l>-v» jJh OJ JA 1 4 / S“*i ^ otJ vfl ^ OV !>; 4 sOA *4?>> Oi u*i>V(iAnd (remember) when We sent towards you a group of the Jinn, listening to the Qur'an. When they stood in the presence thereof, they said: “Listen in silence!” And when it was finished, they returned to their people, as wamers. They said: ”0 our people! Verily, we have heard a Book sent down after Musa, confirming what came before it, it guides to the truth and to the straight way. O our people! Respond to Allah's caller, and believe in him. He (Allah) will forgive you your sins, and will save you from a painful torment (i.e. Hell-fire). And whosoever does not respond to Allah's caller, he cannot escape on earth, and there will be no helpers for him besides Allah. Those are in manifest error.} [46:29-32] A Hadith collected by At-Tirmidhi stated that the Messenger of Allah recited Surat Ar-Rahm&n, to these Jinns, in which Allah said, & sc& iWe shall attend to you, O you two classes (Jinn and men)! Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both (Jinn

472 Tafcir Ibn Kathir ts&znm '*« 4£4-3*^=a; t^Sol £d4l fjlqip and men) deny?} [55:31-32] ” *'''''' r" ^ji» i0?p^==>t_±i1 -> —jiUjO j e-y '*' -' >^— <"^>1 jj ll>i All.i»U^j <r. ^ Allah said in this honorable Ayah, it # £Z£} sA: ^ & £& ilSj ^1. | ^=3Jr & ix). ijfi Ui j^CjJ 4Lit 40 yon assembly ofJinn and humans! “\Did not there come to you Mes- sengers from amongst you, reciting unto you My verses and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?” They will say: "We bear witness against ourselves."} meaning, we affirm that the Messengers have conveyed Your Messages to us and warned us about the meeting with You, and that this Day will certainly occur. Allah said next, itfJ y£K 1^4 '-i -i.-t s“ f > f/i/' * > * >-£r> ""J j ^ : 1 1 & jp-*J^jfrj. 4/f was the life of this world that deceived them.} and they wasted their lives and brought destruction to themselves by rejecting the Messengers and denying their miracles. This is because they were deceived by the beauty, adornment and lusts of this life. intr^& }And they will bear witness against themselves} on the Day of Resurrection, IM TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :177

ty?^} ithat they were disbelievers...} in this worldly life, rejecting what the Messengers, may Allah’s peace and blessings be on them, brought them. iL: 147, JM; j J 4 .’rT , ^ Laj ^231. Tin’s is because your Lord would not destroy the (populations of) towns for their wrongdoing while their people were unaware.} 4132. For all there will be degrees according to what they did. And your Lord is not unaware of what they do.} Allah said, iTItis is because your Lord would not destroy the (populations of) towns far their wrongdoing while their people were unaware.} meaning: “We sent the Messengers and revealed the Books to the Jinns and mankind, so that no one has an excuse that he is being punished for his wrongs although he did not receive Allah’s Message. Therefore, We did not punish any of the nations, except after sending Messengers to them, so that they have no excuse.’ Allah said in other Ayat, & oi iAnd there never was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} [35:24], and ia\ 'jfaj iil J^=> 4 til 4And verily, We have sent among every Umrnah a Messenger (proclaiming) : "Worship Allah, and stay away from At-Tdghut (all false deities)."} [16:36], and }And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger.} [17:15], and,

^ \$k3 '£> pt£qJ \£) 4Every time a group is cast therein, its keeper will ask: "Did no warmer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a warmer did come to us, but we belied him.") [67:8-9) There are many other Ayat on this subject. At-Tabari said, “Allah's statement, t 4For all there will be degrees according to what they did.) means, every person who obeys Allah or behaves disobediently, has grades and ranks according to their works, which Allah gives them as recompense, good for good and evil for evil.” I say, it is possible that Allah’s statement, 4For all there will be degrees according to what they did.) refers to the disbelievers of the Jinns and mankind who will earn a place in the Fire according to their evil deeds. Allah said, 4He ivill say: "For each one there is double (torment)."[7:38), and, Lj <3j> (;Uc S-ir- & i \sj£ 1 «£Ji. x" * '?' 4Those who disbelieved and hinder (others) from the path of Allah, for them We ivill add torment to the torment because they used to spread corruption.) (16:88) Allah said next, o £j) 4And your Lord is not unaware of what they do.) Ibn Jarir commented, “All these deeds that they did, O Muhammad, they did while your Lord is aware of them, and He collects and records these deeds with Him, so that He recompenses them when they meet Him and return to Him.” m At-Tabari 12:125

476 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i&Z if 4And in your place make whom He wills as your successors, who behave obediently, it (^=aLti |2T> 4As He raised you from the seed of other people.} and surely, He is able to do

this, and it is easy for Him. And just as Allah has destroyed the earlier nations and brought their successors, He is able to do away with these generations and bring other people in their place. Allah has also said; Of Jit of J*liil ifS j; III 4lf He wills, He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever Capable ewer that.} (4:133], 40 mankind! It is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is Rich (free of all needs). Worthy of all praise. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation . And that is not hard for Allah.} (35:15-17J, and, 4But Allah is Rich (free of all needs), and you are poor. And if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} (47:38). Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ya'qUb bin TJtbah said that he heard Aban bin TJthman saying about this Ayah, 4<ZrfU> U} 4As He raised you from the seed of other people.} "The seed' means the offspring and the children."* 11 Allah's statement, m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3 :361

iSurely, that which you are promised, will verily, come to pass and you cannot escape. means, tell them, O Muhammad, that what they have been promised of Resurrection will surely occur, •> 4and you cannot escape.} from Allah. Rather, He is able to resurrect you even after you become dust and bones. Certainly, Allah is able to do all things and nothing ever escapes His power. Allah said; 4Say: "O my people! Work according to your way, surely, I too am working and you will come to know."} This contains a stem warning and a sure promise, saying; remain on your way, if you think that you are rightly guided, for I will remain on mine. Allah said in another Ayah, k 12^6 £ ijfcf \$ Jj} 4And say to those who do not believe: "Act according to Makanatikum, We are acting (in our way) . And you wait! We (too) are waiting."} [11:121-122]. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, iaccording to Makanatikum...} means, your way.11 ' f VA %£ jS £ £>£2 4And you will come to know far which of us will be the (happy) end in the Hereafter. Certainly the wrongdoers will not be successful} [6:135], You will come to know if the happy end will be mine (Muhammad's) or yours (the disbelievers). Allah has indeed kept His promise and allowed Muhammad £§ to prevail in the iiT Af-Tabari 12:129

Some Acts of Shirk Allah chastises and criticizes the idolators who invented innovations, Kufr and Shirk, and called on partners and rivals with Allah among His creation, although He created every thing, all praise is due to Him. This is why Allah said, 4And they assign to Allah from that which He has created,) iof the tilth) meaning, fruits and produce, <14*5^2%) iand of the cattle a share) meaning a part and a section. iand they say: "This is for Allah," according to their claim, "and this is for our partners") Allah said next, .— yA A, A\— Z2) iBut the share of their "partners " reaches not Allah, while the share of Allah reaches their "partners' !) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-'Awfi narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said; "When they, the enemies of Allah, would cultivate the land or collect produce, they would assign a part of it to Allah and another part to the idol. They would keep the share for the idol, whether land, produce or anything else, and preserve its division to such an extent that they would collect anything that accidentally falls from the share they assigned to Allah and add it to the share of the idol. If the water that they assigned for the idol irrigated something (a section of land, for instance) that they assigned for Allah, they would add whatever this water irrigated to the idol's share! If the land or produce that they assigned for Allah was accidentally mixed with the share that they assigned for the idol, they would say that the idol is poor. Therefore, they would add it to the share they assigned for the idol and would not return it to the share

Jr Ibn KathirE they assigned for Allah. If the water that they assigned for Allah irrigated what they assigned for the idol they would leave it (the produce) for the idol. They also made some of their other property sacred, like the Bahirah, Sa'ibah, WasUah and Ham, assigning them to the idols, claiming that they do so as way of seeking a means of approach to Allah. Allah said, ^ 40“ill y lji LLj ji. 4And they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created... Similar was said by Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.'21 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented; “Every type of slaughter that they would assign for Allah, would never be eaten unless they mentioned the names of their idols when slaughtering it. Yet for what they sacrificed in the names of the idols, they would not mention Allah's Name when slaughtering it.” He then recited the Ayah (6:136) until he reached, 4Evil is the way theyjudge!^ This Ayah means, evil is that which they determined, for they committed error in the division. Certainly, Allah is the Lord, Owner and Creator of all things and His is the dominion. All things are His property and under His supreme control, will and decree. There is no deity worthy of worship, or Lord, except Him. And even when the polytheists made this evil division, they did not preserve it, but cheated in it. Allah said in other Ayat, *11 y 4And they assign daughters unto Allah - glory be to Him - and unto themselves what they desire (16:57), and 4Yet, they assign to some of His servants a share with Him. At-Tabari 12:131-132 At-Tabari 12:133 131 At-Tabari 12:134

481Surah 6. Al-An'dm (137) (Part-8) Verily, man is indeed a manifest ingrate!} [43:151, and, ils itfor you the mates and for Him thefemales? That indeed is a division most unfair!} (53:21-22). jjj uvAr ..ll c iif i; ^ i^jb; ^137. And so to many of the idolators, their "partners" have made fair seeming the killing of their children, in order to lead than to their own destruction and cause confusion in their religion. And ifAllah Imd willed, they would not have done so. So leave them alone with theirfabrications.} Shaytan Lured the Idolators to Kill Their Children Allah says, just as the Shayatin lured the idolators to assign a share for Allah from what He created of agriculture and cattle - and a share for the idols, they also made it seem fair for them to kill their children, for fear of poverty, and burying their daughters alive, for fear of dishonor. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he commented; 4And so to many of the idolators, their "partners" have made fair seaning the killing of their children...} “They make killing their children attractive to them.”01 Mujahid said, “Idolators’ partners among the devils ordered them to bury their children for fear of poverty.”,2) As-Suddi said, “The devils commanded them to kill their daughters so that they. Head than to ttheir own destruction}, and to, 01 At-Tabari 12:136 At-Tabari 12:136.

482 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 4 t^ii tcause confusion in their religion.y™ Allah said, 4?£3 c "if tti 4And if Allah had willed, they would not have done so.} meaning, all this occurred by Allah's leave, will and decree, but He dislikes these practices, and He has the perfect wisdom in every decree. He is never questioned about what He does, but they all will be questioned. 4So leave them alone with theirfabrications.} meaning, avoid and abandon them and what they do, for Allah will judge between you and them. 4 . \ r>Xi' <,\±==>J^ a s <. ' < '<<454 » , ' f s \$»rj} ^==u>- i ur J ,,-ib ijte- Hj C*£ if id 5\$J -J JBfe U&# 4138. And according to their claim, they say that such and such cattle and crops are Hijr (forbidden), and none should eat of them except those whom we allow. And (they say) there are cattle forbidden to be used for burden, and cattle on which (at slaughtering) the Name of Allah is not pronounced ; lying 111 At-Tabari 12:137

483 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (138) (Part-8) against Him (Allah). He will recompense them for what they used to fabricate.} The Idolators Forbade Certain Types of Cattle 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Hijr refers to what they forbade, such as the Wastlah, and the like." 111 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-l?ahh&k, As-Suddi, Qatadah, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others.*2 Qatadah commented on, iThey say that such and such cattle and crops are Hijr,} "It is a prohibition that the Shayatin appointed for their wealth, and a type of exaggeration and extremism that did not come from Allah." ['Abdur-Rahman] Ibn Zayd bin Aslam said that, iHijr,} refers to what the idolators deities. 131 As-Suddi said that the Ayah, designated for their iAnd none should eat of them except those whom we allow, they claimed. . . } means, "They said, only those whom we choose can eat of them., and the rest are prohibited from eating them."*41 Similar to this honorable Ayah, Allah said, j&J 'it ji Mij t\j a £5 'it jy e \$} 4 Say : "Tell me, what provision Allah has sent down to you! And you have made of it lawful and unlawful." Say: "Has Allah permitted you (to do so), or do you invent a lie against Allah?"} [10:59], At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143 At-Tabari 12:143

and, \$ jc iujju ij "ij fr?J 'Sj /?{t- "h £>; iAllah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sd'ibah or a Wasilah or a Ham. But those who disbelieve invent lies against Allah, and most of them have no understanding.} [5:103] As-Suddi said that cattle forbidden to be used for burden were the Bahirah, Sa'ibah, Wasilah and Ham, as well as cattle for which the idolators did not mention Allah's Name when slaughtering them nor when they were bom. Abu Bakr bin 'Ayyash said that 'Asim bin Abi An-Najud said, "Abu Wa'il said to me, 'Do you know the meaning of the Ayah, & ill up* 2% G&fIC^ iAnd (they say) there are cattle forbidden to be used for burden, and cattle on which the Name of Allah is not pronounced.} I said, 140.' He said, "It is the Bahirah, which they would not use to for Hajj (either by riding it or carrying things on it).'" Mujahid also said that they were some of the camels belonging to idolators on which Allah's Name was not mentioned when riding, milking, carrying things, copulation or any other action.*21 Hying against Him.} against Allah. The idolators indeed lied when they attributed this evil to Allah's religion and Law; He did not allow them to do that nor did He approve of it. 4He will recompense them for what they used to fabricate.} against Him, and falsely attribute to Him. o&s& SyM jjia £ M | *<&=&,l * At-Tabari 12:144 121 At-Jabari 12:145

4139. And they say: "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone, and forbidden to our females, but if it is bom dead, then all have slmres therein." He will punish them for their attribution (of such false orders to Allah). Verily, He is All-Wise, All-Knower.} Abu Ishaq As-Subayl narrated that 'Abdullah bin Abi Al- Hudhayl reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, ifyM I&JL ^ 4And they say : "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone..." } refers to milk. 'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah, 4And they say: "What is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone. "It is about milk, which they prohibited for their females and allowed only their males to drink. When a sheep would give birth to a male sheep, they would slaughter it and feed it to their males, but not to their females. If the newly bom lamb was a female, they would not slaughter it, but if it was stillborn, they would share in it (with their females)! Allah forbade this practice."*2 * Similar was said by As-Suddi.*3' Ash-Sha'bi said, "The Bahirah' milk was only given to the men. But if any cattle from the Bahirah died, both men and women would share in eating it." Similar was said by 'Ikrimah, Qatadah and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Mujahid commented; 4And they say : "Wlwt is in the bellies of such and such cattle is for our males alone, and forbidden to our females.. ." } "It

refers to the Sa'ibah and the Bahirah." * Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Allah's statement, At-Tabari 12:146 * At-Tabari 12:147 * At-Tabari 12:148 At-Tabari 12:148

4He will punish them for their attribution.} means, uttering such falsehood.' This is explained by Allah's statement. 5 LOS uij jfcSyf .U O i#S •\$> 4^0^4? y 4fl Jp ojj^i uj. 4And say not concerning that which your tongues falsely utter: "This is lawful and this is forbidden." so as to invent lies against Allah. Verily, those who invent lies against Allah will never prosper.} [16 :116] Allah said, 4Verily, He is All-Wise.} in His actions, statements. Law and decree, 4All-Knower}, in the actions of His servants, whether good or evil, and He will recompense them for these deeds completely. \$E 'S^ Z} 4^-^ifai* iy&=> Uj ifee IS 4140. Indeed lost are they who have killed their children, foolishly, without knowledge, and (they) have forbidden that which Allah has provided for them, inventing a lie against Allah. They have indeed gone astray and were not guided.} All&h says that those who committed these evil acts have earned the loss of this life and the Hereafter. As for this life, they lost when they killed their children and made it difficult for themselves by prohibiting some types of their wealth, as an act of innovation that they invented on their own. As for the Hereafter, they will end up in the worst dwellings, because they used to lie about Allah and invent falsehood about Him. Allah also said, HI At-Tabari 12:152

"Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful." (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} [10:69-70] Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr bin Marduwyah recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "If it pleases you to know how ignorant the Arabs used to be, then recite the Ayat beyond Ayah one hundred and thirty in Surat Al-An'am, \$ jp •bi-1' L. ft Jju i!+iS fr~>- Ji} 4W-,^.*Z^ Cj 'i indeed lost are they who have killed their children, foolishly, without knowledge, and [they] have forbidden that which Allah has provided for them, inventing a lie against Allah. They have indeed gone astray and were not guided.}" Al-Bukhari also recorded this in the section of his Sahih on

the virtues of the Quraysh .

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pj gifj 12* isii% 0} it," ""A>j» *jl>. IyV»j j*-> I '•*1 >r-t*« ^ 44 * iid. ^ &p&0*vA (A£%&ph i* tffc-4141. And it is He Who produces gardens Ma'rushdt and not Ma'rushdt, and date palms, and crops of different shape and taste, and olives, and pomegranates, similar, and different. Eat of their fruit when they ripen, but pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest, and waste not by extravagance. Verily, He likes not the wasteful.} 4142. And of the cattle (are some) for burden and (some smaller) for Farsh. Eat of what Allah has provided for you, and follow not the footsteps of Shaytan. Surely, he is to you an open enemy.}

Allah Created the Produce, Seed Grains and Cattle Allah states that He created everything, including the produce, fruits and cattle that the idolators mishandled by their misguided ideas, dividing them into various designated parts, allowing some and prohibiting some. Allah said, / < ;/ S-" sA'V 4And it is He Who produces gardens Ma'rushdt and not Ma'rushdt,) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Ma'rushat refers to what the people trellise, while 'not Ma'rushdt refers to fruits (and

produce) that grow wild inland and on mountains.”* 11 ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Ma’rushdt are the grapevines that are trellised, while hot Ma’rushdt refers to grapevines that are not trellised.” As- Suddi said similarly. As for these fruits being similar, yet different, Ibn Jurayj said, “They are similar in shape, but different in taste. ”*2 ‘ Muhammad bin Ka*b said that the Ayah, 4Eat of theirfruit when they ripen,\$ means, “(Eat) from the dates and grapes they produce.” ’3 Allah said next, jLii. ibut pay the due thereofon the day of their harvest,) Mujahid commented, “When the poor people are present (on

the day of harvest), give them some of the produce.”*4’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1810–1870]

‘Abdur- Razzaq recorded that Mujahid commented on the Ayah, <a>- *j5»j^ ibut pay the due thereofon the day of their harvest.) “When planting, one gives away handfuls (of seed grains) and on harvest, he gives away handfuls and allows them to pick 111 At-Jabari 12:156 * At-Jabari 12:157 ' At-Tabari 12:157 * At-Jabari 12:163

whatever is left on the ground of the harvest.”111 Ath-Thawri said that Hammad narrated that Ibrahim An-Nakha! said, “One gives away some of the hay.”121 Ibn Al-Mubarak said that Shurayk said that Salim said that Sa’Id bin Jubayr commented; *JL»- 4but pay the due thereofon the day of their harvest “This ruling, giving the poor the handfuls (of seed grains) and some of the hay as food for their animals, was before Zakah became obligatory.” Allah has chastised those who harvest, without giving away a part of it as charity. Allah mentioned the story of the owners of the garden in Surat Nun, >j dLSf o? ££ % :.v; % y# Ib-ii if je jjaej yHjJ V Ji itiigsuZ & y# •iQji&gi VJ j»i jl js fyiiyjj* & j? IJjri J J#-* ill Uy, ijli je. Jjli ‘ IV, 4 jtt, ijil? j) y»|9i v’ilj £> dl H) S^i- iWhen they swore to pluck the fruits of the (garden) in the morning. Without saying: "If Allah wills." Then there passed by on the (garden) a visitation (fire) from your Lord at night, Burning it while they were asleep. So the (garden) became black by the morning, like a pitch dark night (in complete ruins). Then they called out one to another as soon as the morning broke. Saying: "Go to your tilth in the morning, ifyou would pluck the fruits." So they departed, conversing in secret low tones (saying) . "No poor person shall enter upon you into it today." And they ivent in the morning with strong intention, thinking that they have power (to prevent the poor taking anything of the fruits therefrom). But when they saw the (garden), they said: "Verily, we have gone astray." (Then they ‘Abdur-Razzaq 2:219 At-Jabari 12:165

4And eat and drink but waste not by extravagance. [7:31] In his Sahih, Al-Bukhari recorded a Hadith without a chain of narration; <jLij r; >& t^dij 1.^1; ijft drink and clothe yourselves without extravagance or arrogance.»[1 ' \ Therefore, these Ayat have the same meaning as this Hadith. and Allah knows best. Benefits ofCattle Allah’s statement. 4And of the cattle (are some) for burden and (some smaller) for Farsh. means, He created cattle for you, some of which are suitable for burden, such as camels, and some are Farsh. Ath-Thawri narrated that Abu Ishaq said that Abu Al-Ahwas said that ‘Abdullah said that ‘animals for burden’ are the camels that are used for carrying things, while, ‘Farsh’, refers to small camels. Al-Hakim recorded it and said, “Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it.”121 ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that ‘animals for burden’ refers to the animals that people ride, while, ‘Farsh’ is that they eat (its meat) and milk it. The sheep is not able to carry things, so you

eat its meat and use its wool for covers and mats (or clothes). This statement of ‘Abdur-Rahman is sound, and the following Ayat testify to it, & tj C& 0 15 4Do they not see that We have created for them of what Our Hands have created, the cattle, so that they are their owners. The Book of Clothing, the first chapter, with slightly different wording. It was recorded with a complete chain by Ibn Majah, An-Nasal, and others. 121 Al-yakim 2:317 At-Jabari 12:181

493Surah 6. Al-An'am (143 - 144) (Part-8) J m&m uv it imm ita^VU Js i** ^ ~ ‘ ^oi (Jj* ; * I ^L>-^ '^^j£Zyio6 IS^kVf: ^irsitd \3^*^=^Tjii&gJ^= ri J—yfitJ 1>A^S=> 4jli t£jj ^ jL-> S/jslp jjl^.'y&\c>lje ijy"S/^rii-ILj cljjjfjitt* <j 5U J ^L^c> llli t> Jcj flp IL^Juz^jJSJ A\$4: become the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} [35:6] and. '£££ S' p: -£i f*3j^ ^i-1 iS <'*>\ i '*'>', '-*.*.*' £. OJ tiT il£ja ilp3 ^ gjf 40 Children of Adam! Let not Shaytan deceive you, as he got your parents out of Paradise, stripping them of their raiment, to show them their private parts.} [7:27] and, ijy *C— /yJjwiif -•; tit' .V< . > ^ JO* pSJ pj>j Oji OjJltU 4VV1// you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers .} [18:50] There are many other Aydt on this subject. Q Ort— ff fji. ji jClij j_Lji ^CsiJ uYj' 1 \$fcSlt dji. g£>j^ C~C3} ifffi otj o^ Oy— {CA *-& ^ c£“jSn fj*. ji ij^l jjJI CCjt) J-j*J 'i^=» *»' j* ifjtj' cj*- u£> iit f£=>~Z>j H fjiJ* if^f. V 5#i 0] ^5 jYij o^3' 4243. Eight pairs: of the sheep two (male and female), and of the goats two (male and female). Say: "Has He forbidden the

ilnjbrm me with knowledge if you are truthful. meaning, tell me with sure knowledge, how and when did Allah prohibit what you claimed is prohibited, such as the Bahirah, Sa'ibah, WasUah and Ham etc.? Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah's statement, <<£2f 5*&& <>;£3 '£& } iEight pairs : of the sheep two, and of the goats two. . . } these are four pairs, 4Say : "Has Heforbidden the two males or the twofemales .. ." } I (Allah) did not prohibit any of these. fCjl 3&LLi & } ior (the young) which the wombs of the twofemales enclose?} and does the womb produce but males and females? So why do you prohibit some and allow some others? ilnjbrm me with knowledge if you are truthful.} Allah is saying that all of this is allowed.” ' Allah said. iOr, were you present when Allah ordered you such a thing?} mocking the idolaters ' innovations, and their lies that Allah made sacred what they have prohibited. iP* J-P 4»' jc i&l lfj>} iThen who does more wrong than one who invents a lie against Allah, to lead mankind astray without knowledge.} Therefore, no one is more unjust than the people described here and Xi V S»f <!>^ iCertainly, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.} The person most worthy of this condemnation is 'Amr bin At-Tabari 12:187

496 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Luhay bin Qum'ah. He was the first person to change the religion of the Prophets and designate the Sa'ibah, Wasdah and Ham, as mentioned in the Sahib. to jl liilIJ C'J^ t j Jj ^ jttj Ji* •*{ ^ jji) j-f 1 Ijuli jl /O^ p->d jl L-ji— 4 vj 4145. Say: "7 find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it, unless it be Maytah (a dead animal) or blood poured forth, or the flesh of swine; for that surely, is unclean (Rijs), or immorally slaughtered in the name of other than Alldh. But whosoever is forced by necessity without willful disobedience, nor transgressing due limits; (for him) certainly, your Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. ForbiddenThings Allah commands His servant and Messenger, Muhammad sg, iSay\$ O Muhammad jg to those who prohibited what Allah has provided them, claiming this falsehood to be from Allah, 4&SZ 31uj t j4 41 find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who

wishes to eat it, This Ayah means, I do not find any animals that are prohibited, except these mentioned here. We should mention here that the prohibited things mentioned in Surat Al-Ma'idah and the Hadiths on this subject amend the meaning of this Ayah. For blood poured. ^ Qatadah commented, "Poured blood was prohibited, but the meat that still has some blood in it is 111 Path Al-Bari 8:132

allowed." 111 Al-Humaydi said that Sufyan narrated to us that 'Amr bin Dinar narrated to us, "I said to Jabir bin 'Abdullah, They claim that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ prohibited the meat of donkeys during (the day of) Khaybar.' He said, 'Al-Hakam bin 'Amr narrated that from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ That scholar - referring to Ibn 'Abbas - denied it, reciting the Ayah; cl) 1 4 S 4 Say : "I find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat if. . Al-Bukhari and Abu Dawud collected it. Abu Bakr bin Marduyah and Al-Hakim, in his Mustadrak, recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "During the time of JahUyyah, the people used to eat some things and avoid some other things, because they disliked them. Later on, Allah sent His Prophet ﷺ, revealed His Book, allowed what He allowed, and prohibited what He prohibited. Therefore, whatever Allah allowed is lawful and whatever He prohibited is unlawful. Whatever He did not mention, there is no sin in it." He then recited the Ayah, 'ifi. CfX 3[£ 4 jJy iSay : "I find not in that which has been revealed to me anythingforbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat if This is the wording with Ibn Marduyah. Abu Dawud also recorded this statement, and Al-Hakim said, "Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it."141 Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "A sheep belonging to Sawdah bint Zam'ah died and she said, 'O Allah's Messenger! So-and-so (sheep) has died.' He said, uWhy did you not use its skin?« ApTabari 12:193 121 Al-Humaydi 2 :379 *3) Fath Al-Bari 9 :570 and Abu Dawud 4 :162 * Abu Dawud , 3800 and Al-Hakim 4:115

She said, 'Should we use the skin of a sheep that has died?' Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, o/2 J jiiZlu C ^ jL3 'y :Jii ju uJi» »yJj; of y j^~»3 jf CJiIS Cl jl £^ 1Allah only said, 4Say: "I find not in that which has been revealed to me anything forbidden to be eaten by one who wishes to eat it, except Maytah (a dead animal) or blood poured forth, or the flesh ofswine....) You will not be eating it ifyou tan its skin and benefitfrom it. So she had the sheep skinned, the skin was tanned and made into a water skin that she kept until it wore out."111 Al- Bukhari and an-Nasal collected a similar Had.ith. Allah said, % -g,£ jC(iBut whosoever is forced by necessity without willful disobedience, nor transgressing due limits;) Therefore, whoever is forced by necessity to eat anything that Allah has forbidden in this honorable Ayah, without transgressing his limits, then for him, fyf icertainly, your Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) We mentioned the explanation of this Ayah in Surat Al- Baqarah. This honorable Ayah contradicts the idolators' innovated prohibitions for certain kinds of wealth, relying merely on their misguided ideas, such as the Bahlrah, Sa'ibah, WasUah and Ham. Allah commanded His Messenger ﷺ to inform them that he does not find that such types of animals are prohibited in what Allah revealed to him. In this Ayah, Allah only prohibited dead animals, poured blood, the flesh of swine and what has been slaughtered for something other than Allah. Other things were not prohibited here, but rather treated as that which does not have a ruling, i.e., permissible. Therefore, how do you - idolators — claim that such items are m Ahmad 1 :327 121 Fath Al-B&ri 1 1 :557 and An-Nasal 7 :173

prohibited, and why did you prohibit them when Allah did not prohibit them? ^ 3*-^^ fc Ju'i !X, ms £ jl ji ^ i7 »/ rate <146. And unto tfiose a?/io are Jews, Weforbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and

We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs or their Hawdya, or is mixed up with a bone. Thus We recompensed them for their rebellion. And verily, We are Truthful.} FoodsthatwereProhibitedfortheJewsBecause oftheir Transgression Allah says. We forbade for the Jews every bird and animal with undivided hoof, ' such as the camel, ostrich, duck and goose. Allah said here. iand Weforbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep.. } The Jews used to forbid these types of foods saying that Isratl, or Ya'qub, used to forbid them for himself so they too forbid them. This was mentioned by As-Suddi. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, i&s# JiX £%} iexcept what adheres to their backs} refers to the fat that clings to their backs.*2 * Allah said next, i&'fX }} 4or their Hawdya } that is, the entrails, according to Abu Jafar bin Jarir. He also said, "The meaning here is, 'And from ox and sheep, We forbade their fat for the Jews, except the fat on their backs and what the entrails cany." 'Ali bin Abi Tajhah said that, Ibn *** See the comments on Surah At 'ImrGn, 3 :93 * At-Tabari 12 :202

'Abbas said that the, Hawaya, are the entrails. * Similar was reported from Mujahid,'2 Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak.'3' Allah's statement, 4f&l 4....or is mixed up with a bone.) means, We allowed the Jews the fat that is mixed with bones. Ibn Jurayj commented, "The fat on the rump that is mixed with the tailbone was allowed for them, and also the fat on the legs, head, eyes and what adheres to the bones."*4 ' As-Suddi said similarly.'5 ' Allah said, iThus We recompensed themfar their rebellion.) meaning, We imposed this restriction on them as recompense for their rebellion and defying Our commandments. Allah said in another Ayah, A A Si 4For the wrongdoing of the Jews, We made unlawful far them certain good foods which had been lawful far them - and far their hindering manyfrom Allah's way) [4:160]. Allah's statement, 4And verily. We are Truthful.) means, We were justified in the penalty We gave them. Ibn Jarir commented, "We are Truthful in what We informed you of, O Muhammad; Our forbidding these foods for them, not as they claimed, that Israel merely forbade these things for himself (so they imitated him, they claimed). ""*6 At-Tabari 12:203 At-Tabari 12:204 At-Tabari 12:204 At-Tabari 12:205 * At-Tabari 12:205 At-Tabari 12:206

The Tricks of the Jews, and Allah's Curse 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas narrated, "When Umar bin Al-Khattab was told that Samurah sold liquor, he commented, 'May Allah fight Samurah! Did he not know that the Messenger of Allah sgg said, JUL>J «May Allah curse the Jews! The fats were for- bidden for them, so they melted the fat and sold it.*" This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs. ,l) Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "In the year of the victory of Makkah, I heard Allah's Messenger saying; <1Allah and His Messenger have forbidden selling alcoholic drinks (intoxicants), dead animals, swine and idols. He was asked, What about the fat of dead animals? They are used to dye skins, paint ships and are used as light by the people.' He said, «(l> yk V «No, it is still unlawful .» > > 7*< r * - I - mjA> 9 > // #A yfv . 4*" y pi f . X ^ ^ j*^ j-fti I 1 * Fath Al-Bari4 :483 and Muslim 3 :1207

502 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr He jg then said, ** aj*^ . (J tj&r (>)!*• llJ 2ii jj S^Ji 2>i J;Ui 'May Allah fight the Jews! When Allah forbade them the fats of animals, they melted thefat, sold it and ate its price.d""*1 The Group recorded this Hadith.TM ^ j*iV Jji Vj /j?U J> (^=4j JSi 0^ <147. // they deny you say : "Your Lord is the Owner of vast mercy, and never xoill His wrath be turned backfrom the people who are criminals."> Allah says, if your opponents among the idolaters, Jews and their likes reject you, O Muhammad, Ji |^=4j iSay : "Your Lord is the Owner of vast mercy..."> encouraging them to seek

Allah's vast mercy and follow His Messenger jg, iand never will His wrath be turned backfrom the people who are criminals> discouraging them from defying the Messenger, the Final Prophet, Muhammad jg. Allah often joins encouragement with threats in the Qur'an. Allah said at the end of this Surah: 3 tSlj iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.> [6:165] Allah also said. verily, your Lord is full offorgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment> [13:6], and m Fath Al-B&ri4 :495 121 Fath Al-B&ri 4 :495 , Muslim 3:1207, Abu Dawud 3:356, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi4 :52 1 , An-Nasal 7 :309 and Ibn Mfijah 2 :732

iDeclare untoMy servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} [15:49-50], and W*4y^ ^ J*¥ 4The Forgiver of sin, the Acceptor of repentance, the Severe in punishment.} [40:3] and, 142 jz iVerily, the punishment of your Lord is severe and painful. Verily, He it is Who begins and repeats. And He is Oft- Forgiving, full oflove.H85:12-14]. There are many other Ayat on this subject. sis' ot 44 4)* 'ij t* "Sif 3) ijS^ itJ' U lyrjc. J* J» Ixib iy'i^ oj rd jS &Li^ \$ 0lS I4» V] i.jUS i4ii VJ [£*>4 ,ji£ 3 <SES. p % SjUii; ^ *12 Cr5 -4 4©<4^45 4148. Those who committed Shirk say: "If Allah had willed, we would not have committed Shirk, nor would ourfathers, and we would not have forbidden anything (against His will)." Likewise belied those who were before them, till they tasted Our wrath. Say: "Have you any knowledge (proof) that you can produce before us? Verily, you follow the Zann and you do nothing but lie."} 4149. Say: "With Allah is the perfect proofand argument; had He so willed. He would indeed have guided you all."} 4150. Say: "Bring forward your witnesses, who can testify that Allah has forbidden this." Then if they testify, do not testify with them. And do not follow the vain desires of those who belie Our Ayat, and such as believe not in the Hereafter, and they hold others as equal with their Lord.}

A False Notion and its Rebuttal Here Allah mentioned a debate with the idolators, refuting a false notion they have over their Shirk and the things that they prohibited. They said, surely, Allah has full knowledge of the Shirk we indulge in, and that we forbid some kinds of wealth. Allah is able to change this Shirk by directing us to the faith, - they claimed - and prevent us from falling into disbelief, but He did not do that. Therefore - they said Allah indicated that He willed, decided and agreed that we do all this. They said, Oi Gj*- Vj Lijtji Vj l& ;U }) A "If Allah had willed, we would not have taken partners (in worship) with Him, nor would our fathers, and we would not haveforbidden anything. ")> Allah said in another Ayah, Ju e m AAnd they said : "If it had been the will of the Most Gracious (Allah), we should not have worshipped them (false deities)") [43 :20], Similar is mentioned in Surat An-Nahl. Allah said next, o; C'jS' JmL^) ALikewise belied those who were before them,) for by using and relying on this understanding, the misguided ones before them were led astray. This notion is false and ungrounded, for had it been true, Allah would not have harmed them, destroyed them, aided His honorable Messengers over them, and made them taste His painful punishment. Af* Ji ji ASay : "Have you any knowledge..." that Allah is pleased with you and with your ways, XU Athat you can produce before us.) and make it plain, apparent and clear for us. However,

& vj iVerily, you only folloio the Zann} doubts and wishful thinking, Vi iand you do nothing but lie^ about Allah in the false claims that you utter. Allah said next, ivt*Jwr' it* \$ iijiji iii-i 4Sni/ : "With Allah is the perfect proof and argument; had He so willed,'He would indeed have guided you all."} Allah said

to His Prophet jg iSay} O Muhammad, to them, i&£i\ i*£U i“With Allah is the perfect proof and argument...”} the perfect wisdom and unequivocal proof to guide whom He wills and misguidewhom He wills. 55. yi} ihad He so willed, He would indeed have guided you all.} All of this happens accordng to His decree. His will, and His choice. So in this way, He is pleased with the believers, and angry with the disbelievers. Allah said in other Ayat, «*»' its 'fj} iAnd had Allah willed, He could have gathered them together (all) on true guidance,} [6:35] and 4u?& 4£ '<& '45 55. jb> iAnd had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together.} [10:99] and, lily (jA V] iJw'ofitii V_> »JA-'J iil jl Jii <itj 5i <\$4*3 iJt^ 3*V ic; ^2- / your Lord had so willed. He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree.

506 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled ",Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinns and men all together.") [11:118-119] Ad-Dahhfik said, “No one has an excuse if he disobeys Allah. Surely, Allah has the perfect proof established against His servants.” Allah said, P& 4Bringforward your witnesses,) produce your witnesses, iwho can testify that Allah has forbidden this.) which you have forbidden and lied and invented about Allah in this regard, iThen if they testify, do not testify with them.) because in this case, their testimony is false and untrue, -> -#/ ijitj vSi*svL cZ/M y5 4j) iAnd do not follow the vain desires of those who belie Our Aydt, and such as believe not in the Hereafter, and they hold others as equal with their Lord.) by associating others with Allah in worship and treating them as equals to Him. ~'- ~i &&& 'ft 'Jp5 ^1 <^=*4* |ife=4j sQ £ 'tj ^=oj/ Si rjlil >/j .ij fXlij ijLi vj ,^34 Ih^j 4^5^ 4252 . Say : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from : Join not anything in worship with Him ; be kind and dutiful to your parents; kill not your children because of poverty - We provide sustenance for you and for them. Come not near to Al-Fawdhish (immoral sins) whether committed

507Surah 6. Al-An'dm (151) (Part-8) openly or secretly; and kill not anyone whom Allah has forbidden, except for a just cause. This He has commanded you that you may understand."} TenCommandments Dawud Al-Awdy narrated that, Ash-Sha'bi said that, 'Alqamah said that Ibn Mas'Gd said, “Whoever wishes to read the will and testament of the Messenger of Allah jgj on which he placed his seal, let him read these Ayat, pi\$ c&wa iSay : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from: join not anything in worship with Him..."} until, -fU*} 4...so that you may have Taqwa} [6:153]. "I 11 In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, “In Surah Al-An'am (6), there are clear Ay&t, and they are the Mother of the Book (the Qur'an).” He then recited, 4Say : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from..."} Al-Hakim said, “Its chain is Sahih, and they did not record it.’ In his Mustadrak Al-Hakim also recorded that “Ubadah bin As-Samit said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said, *Who among you will give me his pledge to do three things?» He then recited the Ayah, c& ijSKS \$} 4Say : "Come, I will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from..."} TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :446 121 Al-HSkm 2:317

508 Tafcir Ibn Kathir until the end of the Ayat. He then said, cJl? U;oJl <3il *Sjiti £3. Jaj jil (JU oyj-ti ^yj lip £li ijjj 4jjp ^Lt jl <J)1 ^1 o^*11 oy-'Sl yi-1 yaj ,Oyp «W/ioeyer fulfills (this pledge), then his reward will be with Allah, but whoever fell into shortcomings and Allah punishes him for it in this life, then that will be his recompense. Wlwever Allah delays (Ids reckoning) until the Hereafter, then his matter is with Allah. IfHe wills, He will punish him, and ifHe wills, He willforgive Al-Hakim said, “Its

chain is Sahih and they did not record it.” 1 ! ' ' ‘ As for the explanation of this Ayah, Allah said to His Prophet and Messenger Muhammad jg: Say, O Muhammad, to those idolators who worshipped other than Allah, forbade what Allah provided them with and killed their children, following their opinions and the lures of the devils,’ 43*^ 4S«y^ to them 4Come} come here, come close j£=4; '\$£. c 41 will recite what your Lord has prohibited you from.} meaning, I will inform you about what your Lord has forbidden for you in truth, not guessing or wishful thinking. Rather, it is revelation and an order from Him. Shirk is Forbidden 4Join not anything in worship with Him;} this Allah has ordained, for He said at the end of the Ayah, -4 £&*) 111 Al-yakim 2:318

509 Surah 6. Al-An'am (151) (Part-8) iThis He has commanded you that you may understand.\$ In the the Two Sahih, it is recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah said, OJj ib.i ^jA 1* . . t «SJL N OjL* ^jA I :JU op J>j jp >-3j^ jp ,Jj jp : Jli jp J'o jp jp Pj-- jp jp :0^ ?Pj— jp Jf3 jp 'Py* jp jp 0Jibril came to me and conveyed the good news that, "Whoever among your followers dies, worshipping none along with Allah, will enter Paradise." I said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse?" He said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse." I said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse?" He said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse." I said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse?" He said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse." I said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse?" He said, "Even if he stole or committed illegal sexual intercourse or even if drank alcohol."^ Some of the Musnad and Sunan compilers recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah said, <li^A jl5 U |Jtp PlJ jAf-\ JJ Jtl>| ^jl yj>\ j yf^C iJjAlJ yj>, hj£j U i'joHa ty'jii Pl^ ^jS/l jp 'Jt\$ Xi ®PlJ ojoi. jU-Pl jlip b\j\\$2PA op 1 *Allah said, 'O Son of Adam! As long as you supplicate to Me and hope of Me, I will forgive whatever you committed, and it will be easy for Me to do that. And even if you brought the earth's fill of sins to Me, I will bring forth its fill of forgiveness, as long as you do not associate anything or anyone in worship with Me. And even if you err and your errors accumulate until they reach the boundaries of the sky and you then ask Me for forgiveness, I will forgive you.'d2 This subject is also mentioned in the Qur'an, for Allah said, I1 * Al-Bukhari no. 1237 and Muslim: 94 Ahmad 5 :172 and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadh from Anas 9 :524

<Sj.'i £»J C jifc J 'i& !>j^ iVerily, Allah forgives not (the sin of) setting up partners (in worship) with Him, but He forgives whom He will, sins other than that [4:116] Muslim recorded a Hadith in the Sahih that reads, 4.1 h ioU -ft «Whoever dies associating none with Allah will enter Paradise There are many Ayat and Hadiths on this subject. The Order for Kindness to Parents Allah said next, be kind and dutiful to your parents meaning, Allah has commanded and ordered you to be kind to your parents. Allah said in another Ayah, % S£s\$& tgft iAnd your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him And that you be dutiful to your parents [17:23] Allah often mentions obeying Him and being dutiful to parents together. Allah said, 3i2 Si d i%us^ iGive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination. But if they (both) strive with you to make you join in worship with Me others that of which you have no knowledge, then obey them not; but behave with them in this world kindly, and follow the path of him who turns to Me in repentance and in obedience. Then to Me will be your return, and I shall tell you what you used to do [31:14-15] IM Muslim 1 :94

511 Surah 6. Al-An'am (151) (Part-8) Therefore, Allah ordered children to be dutiful and kind to their parents, even if they were idolaters. Allah also said, Si' iuW «> H X.HX-l tji (3- t ^ 4And (remember)

when We took a covenant from the Children of Israel, (saying) : Worship none but Allah and be dutiful and kind to parents.} [2 :83] There are several Ayat on this subject. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas'ud said, "I asked Allah's Messenger about which deed is the best. He said, * 1 i'hZaiU *The prayer, when it is performed on time. I said, Then?' He said, «Being dutiful to parents .» I asked, Then?' He said, 4ji 1 Jt «Jihad in Allah's cause. Ibn Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said these words to me, and had I asked him for more, he would have said more." Killing Children is Forbidden Allah said, & 9^*1 o; ^j} 4K.Ul not your children because of poverty, We shall provide sustenancefor you andfor them.} After Allah commanded kindness to parents and grandparents, He next ordered kindness to children and grandchildren. Allah said, oj v)sL -tj} 4kill not your children because ofpoverty,} ^ Fath Al-Bari2:12 and Muslim 1 :89

512 Tafstr Ibn Kathir because the idolaters used to kill their children, obeying the lures of the devils. They used to bury their daughters alive for fear of shame, and sometimes kill their sons for fear of poverty. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "I asked the Messenger of Allah "Which sin is the biggest?' He said, jAj IX 4A) jl® "To call a rivalfor Allah, while He Alone created youj I said, Then what?' He said, jf 4— >- iljljj jl® "To kill your son forfear that he might share yourfood I said, Then what?' He said, '1X>- of® "To commit adultery with your neighbor's wifoj Then the Messenger of Allah sg recited the Ayah, ill pj*. jll V iAnd those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause, nor commit illegal sexual intercourse [25:68], fl Allah's statement, ^Because of Irnlaq} refers to poverty, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.*2 ' The Ayah means, do not kill your children because you are poor. Allah said in Surat Al-Isra', ^ \$2 iAnd do not kill your children forfearfrom Imlaq [17:31], that is, do not kill your children for fear that you might become poor in the future. This is why Allah said, **' PathAl-Bari 8:350 and Muslim 1 :98 At-Tabari 12:217

4We shall provide sustenancefor them andfor you [17:31], thus mentioning the provision of the children first, meaning, do not fear poverty because of feeding your children. Certainly, their provision is provided by Allah. Allah said, jpir >f. 4We provide sustenancefor you andfor them,} thus starting with parents, because this is the appropriate subject here and Allah knows. Allah said next, iCome not near Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly Allah said in a similar Ayah, CA A 2 c34\$%£ fr i c\$\$ y#& tioi j>; i iSay : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly, sins (of all kinds), unrighteous oppression, joining partners (in worship) with Allah for which He has given no authority, and saying things about Allah ofwhich you have no knowledge."} [7:33] We also explained this meaning in the explanation of the Ayah, i/Aj} }Leave sin, open and secret} [6:120]. The Two Sahihs recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah said, ^4* fir* ^ \A~ ^4* dre b "None is more jealous than Allah. Tins is why He has forbidden the immoral sins committed openly or secretly .n 1 ' 1 m Fath Al-Bari 8 :146 and Muslim 4 :21 14

514 Tafsir Ibit Kathir 'Abdul-Malik bin TJmayr said that Warrad narrated that Al- Mughlrah said that Sa'd bin TJbadah said, "If I see a man with my wife (committing adultery), I will kill him with the sword." When the matter came to the Messenger of Allah jg, he said, dlli b*- bi ^ iJy bi 'b^ Q ^ (y- "Do you wonder at Sa'd's jealousy? By Allah, I am more jealous than Sa'd, and Allah is more jealous than I.

This is why He has forbidden the immoral sins committed openly and in secret. » This Hadith is in the Two Sahih's. The Prohibition of Unjustified Killing Allah said, 4^1 V) 'll) ff- 4And kill not anyone whom Allah has forbidden, except for a just cause (according to Islamic law).} This part of the Ayah emphasizes this prohibition in specific, although it is included in the immoral sins committed openly and in secret. In the Two Sahih's, it is recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah 5g said, "Jj t4il JyLj j ill Vj «J) N ji (4—* ;S (° jllaJl OjJ iljtllj 1^—iJt l ^1^1 v»~lll ! “77/e blood of a Muslim perscnt who testifies that there is no deity ivorthy of worship except Allah and that I am the Messenger of Allah is prohibited, except for three offenses : a married person who commits illegal sexual intercourse, life for life, and whoever reverts from the religion and abandons the jama'ah (the community offaithfiil believers).^ There is a prohibition, a warning and a threat against killing the Mu'ahid, i.e., non-Muslims who have a treaty of peace with Muslims. Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said that the Prophet jg said, 111 Fath Al-Bari 13:411 and Muslim 2:1136 ^ Fath Al-Bari 12 :209 and Muslim 3 : 1302

J ussmi mm t- *" ^ ^ _ ^ 'i ^ -ft' »> •:. '*?' • > .X-£joj 'JoL^=>j!j >jus > _>L\$-«-- (u?)^L>i£j* ** (iSCLCaj ijijl4iit ~" t >1£•£'•" s> ' i *1 pi^Xfu-u^j^ j^ (^**JpO y^-*2**j ^tS3jU? 0&&& 3O^d^J&Joi 4^J '6£#SI\$ ' >i^3'\$ *»«j £>- ^ '3*Ui Jm ji» “Whoever killed a person having a treaty ofprotec- tion with Muslims, shall not smell the scent of Paradise, though its scent is perceived from a distance of forty years, s’ 1 Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet jg said, jii & 2 il*u: j=i ^ *6 ; .1 • f •£? , >* is-- 4*Jb j^L>- 1 Jui* *J OjJ i&Jl lA5»3 & ijijl ?3rr* ji 4^-J jp oAr- aWhoever killed a person having a treaty ofprotection with the Muslitns, and who enjoys the guarantee of Allah and His Messenger, he will have spoiled the guarantee of Allah [for him]. He shall not smell the scent of Paradise though its smell is perceivedfrom a distance ofseventy years. Ibn Majah and At-Tirmidhi recorded this Hadith, and At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan SahOi.” I2 * Allah’s statement, 4o&i .* fcZv wSS& tfcoj43>j4itc-4V*j vjibl ijwj Oj»J—a> drf tfijj jp (.UU 4T7n’s He has commanded you that you may understand> means, this is what He has commanded you that you may comprehend His commandments and prohibitions. 111 FathAl-Bari 12:370 * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi4 :658 and Ibn Majah 2 : 896

516 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr oljuJ’j ijijlj jiiit ^ ^ |>-»3 JC Yj^ <if j li olfes j!j IjIacS jili ljlj V+a-Ij VJ^ L. ai LiKj 'll ^Ijlc 4^«£»i&S «i» ^I*J 4152. "And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it, until he (or she) attains the age offull strength; and give full measure and full weight with justice ." - We burden not any person, but that which he can bear - "And whenever you speak, say the truth even if a near relative is concerned, and fulfill the covenant of Allah. This He commands you, that you may remember."} The Prohibition of Consuming the Orphan’s Property Ata’ bin As-Sa’ib said that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, “When Allah revealed, 4And come not near to the orphan's property, except to improve it.} and, 4ult 1\$ 6^ iVerily, those who unjustly eat up the property oforphans. } those who were guardians of orphans separated their food from the orphans’ food and their drink from their drink. When any of that food or drink remained, they used to keep it for the orphan until he or she ate it or it spoiled. This became difficult for the companions and they talked about it to the Messenger of Allah sg, and Allah sent down the Ayah, 4And they ask you about orphans. Say: “The best thing is to work honestly in their property, and if you mix your affairs with theirs, then they are your brothers.”}

[2:220] Thereafter, they mixed their food and drink with food and drink of the orphans.” Abu Dawud collected this statement. Allah’s statement, 111 Abu Dawud 3 :291

%&} iuntil he (or she) attains the age offull strength;}, refers to reaching the age of adolescence, according to Ash- Sha*bi, Malik and several others among the Salaf. 11 ' The Command to Give Full Measure and Full Weight with Justice Allah’s statement, iand givefull measure and full weight with justice.} is a command to establish justice while giving and taking. Allah has also warned against abandoning this commandment, when He said, j' (v*yo ; yjJ O-U');'o&4 's tfSf 4 Q& OyyCi ^ Jipjl \$j} & Vi 4>Woe to Al-Mutaffifin . Those who, when they have to receive by measure from men, demand fill measure. And when they have to give by measure or weight to (other) men, give less than due. Do they not think that they will be resurrected (for reckoning). On a Great Day? Tlte Day when (all) mankind will stand before the Lord ofall that exists?} [83:1-6]. Allah destroyed an entire nation that was accustomed to giving less in weights and measures.¹²¹ Allah said next, Vi 4We burden not any person, but that which he can bear.} that is, whoever strives while pursuing his rights and giving other peoples’ full rights, then there is no sin on him if he commits an honest mistake after trying his best and striving to do what is right. 111 At-Tabari 12:223 ¹²¹ That is, the nation ofProphet Shu‘ayb, see SuratAl-A‘raf7:85-92.

The Order for Just Testimony Allah said; iE> 6S&. jlJ ^ii whenever you give your word, say the truth even if a near relative is concerned.} This is similar to His statement, 40 you who believe! Stand out firmly Jbr Allah as just witnesses.} [5:8] And there is a similar Ayah in Surat An-Nisa’. So Allah commands justice in action and statement, with both near relatives and distant relatives. Indeed, Allah orders justice for everyone at all times and in all situations. Fulfilling the Covenant ofAllah is an Obligation Allah said next, jif J~i^>j} iand fulfill the Covenant ofAllah.} Ibn Jarir commented, “Allah commands: Fulfill Allah’s commandments that He has ordered you. You will do so when you obey Him in what He commanded, refrain from what He prohibited and abide by His Book and the Sunnah of His Messenger \$E|. This constitutes fulfilling the covenant ofAllah, 4...This He commands you, that you may remember.} Allah says here, that this is what He has ordered and commanded, and He stressed its importance for you, 4...that you may remember.}, that you may be advised and thus refrain from what you used to do before this.” m At-Tabari 12:225

iji-iU 4 ljE o1j^> 4."'.0>ii3 (v^==*^ «W>J 4153. "And verily, this is My straight path, so fallozv it, and follow not (other) paths, far they will separate you away from His path. This He has ordained far you that you may have Taqwd The Command to Follow Allah’s Straight Path and to Avoid All Other Paths ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statements, ft^^ iAnd fallow not (other) paths, far they will separate you away from His path.}, and, 4*j, iji/W "ij ctiJ' If)} ify 4(Saying) that you should establish religion and make no divisions in it.} [42:13], and similar Ayat in the Qur’an, “Allah commanded the believers to adhere to the Jamd'ah and forbade them from causing divisions and disputes. He informed them that those before them were destroyed because of divisions and disputes in the religion of Allah.” 1 11 Similar was said by Mujahid and several others.¹²¹ Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, “The Messenger of Allah jg drew a line with his hand (in the sand) and said, «U-£Ll3 «iil J~c» IJui “This is Allah’s path, leading straight .» He then drew

lines to the right and left of that line and said, *Ua^ Nl jJ—^ 14-; 'J Jjll ;4* s* “These are the other paths, on each path there is a devil who At-Tabari 12:229 At-Tabari 12 :229

calls to it . He then recited, **Ar :i l.« . * J:>? Oii i*And verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path.}[6:l53Y 1] Al-Hakim also recorded this *HacLlth* and said; “Its chain is Sahih, but they did not record it.”¹² Imam Ahmad and ‘Abd bin Humayd recorded (and this is the wording of Ahmad) that Jabir said; “We were sitting with the Prophet *jj* when he drew a line in front of him and said, *<<3)l J—C. Ijui>* “This is Allah's path.o He also drew two lines to its right and two lines to its left and said, *•Olkl ll .0 i*These are the paths of Shaytan . He then placed his hand on the middle path and recited this Ayah; *J&i ^ !A£ ij ijjfc CoLli %)>* iAnd verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path. This He has ordained for you that you may have *Taqwd.*}¹³¹ Imam Ahmad, Ibn Majah, in the Book of the Sunnah in his Sunan, and Al-Bazzar collected this Hadith¹⁴ ' Ibn Jarir recorded that a man asked Ibn Mas^d, “What is As-Sirat Al- Mustaqim (the straight path)?” Ibn Mas'ud replied, 1,1 Ahmad 1 :465 121 Al-Hakim 2:318 Ahmad 3:397 and ‘Abd bin Humayd no. 345 * Ibn Majah : 1

521 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (153) (Part-8) “Muhammad *gg* left us at its lower end and its other end is in Paradise. To the right of this Path are other paths, and to the left of it are other paths, and there are men (on these paths) calling those who pass by them. Whoever goes on the other paths will end up in the Fire. Whoever takes the Straight Path, will end up in Paradise.” Ibn Mas'ud then recited the Ayah; *ili i*And verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and follow not (other) paths, for they will separate you away from His path.y Imam Ahmad recorded that, An-Nawwas bin Sam'an said that the Messenger of Allah *gg* said. *p j2ai\ Ifoj i ')& <1)1 <1/^# 1^X1* Ij : fA* j >—'t^Sf jljl jf-Oj £)ij 'Ij , .. ,,, 1 1 IjJLsJ-jl Alia jj kiliU JilJ)ja £&£ dl ^j\ JIJij <1)1 w^T^'V tj <1)1 jjJL>- 1? Ij tiUi (ir! ' <#1 j-'j »A//oh />as* *giaen* a parable of the straight path, and on tire two sides of this path, there are two walls containing door ways. On these door ways, there are curtains that are lowered down on the gate of this path there is a caller heralding, 'O people! come and enter the straight path all together and do not divide.' There is also another caller that heralds from above the path, who says when a person wants to remove the curtain on any of these doors, 'Woe to you! Do not open this door, for if you open it, you will enter it. The (straight) path is Islam, the two walls are Allah's set limits, the open doors lead to Allah's prohibitions, the caller on the gate of the path is Allah's Book (the Qur'an), while the caller from above the path is Allah's admonition in the heart of every Muslim. »*2I 111 At-Tabari 12:230 [21 Ahmad 4:182

At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal also recorded this Hadith, and At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib Allah's statement, 4sofollow it, andfollow not (other) paths...} describes Allah's path in the singular sense, because truth is one. Allah describes the other paths in the plural, because they are many and are divided. Allah said in another Ayah, *iAlldh* is the Wall (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darknesses into light. But as for those who disbelieve, their supporters are *Tdghut* (false deities), they bring them out from light into darknesses. Those are the dwellers of the Fire, and they will abide therein forever.} [2:257) *AJyj ijXtj 1ZM V, f.\ 4154*. Then, We gave Musa the Book [the Tawrah], complete for that which is best, and explaining all things in detail and a guidance and a mercy that they might believe in the meeting with their Lord.} 4155. And this is a blessed Book (the

Qur'an) which We have sent down, so follow it and have Taqwa, so that you may receive mercy.} Praising the Tawrah and the Qur'an After Allah described the Qur'an by saying, 4'y^i ;« -i 'ii o*j} 4And verily, this is My straight path, so follow it...} He then praised the Tawrah and its Messenger, [il Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:152 and An-Nasal

Sarah 6. Al-An'dm (154 - 155) (Part-8) 523 iThen, We gave Musa the Book...} Allah often mentions the Qur'an and the Tawrah together. Allah said, W-3 liUj 2yyt u*j} iAnd before this was the Scripture of Musa as a guide and a mercy. And this is a confirming Book in the Arabic language.} [46:12]. Allah said in the beginning of this Surah, Cj> Cry -A& Sf & iU iSay : "Who then sent down the Book which Musa brought, a light and a guidance to mankind which you have made into paper sheets, disclosing (some of it) and concealing (much)?" (6:91), and iXC iAnd this is a blessed Book which we have sent down...} [6:92] Allah said about the idolaters, iBut when the truth has come to them from Us, they say: "Why is he not given the like of what was given to Musa?"} [28:48]. Allah replied. IjSli) iri'L 1^6 Jj j* lyy^ iL j jJ\$} i"Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old?" They say: "Two kinds of magic [the Tawrah and the Qur'an], each helping the other!" And they say : "Verily, in both we are disbelievers."} [28:48] Allah said about the Jinns that they said, Zf4t: Ui lyy jju [y Jjil i"O our people! Verily, we have heard a Book sent down after Miisa, confirming what came before it, it guides to the truth."} [46:30]

Allah's statement, zs\$& CC} 4...complete for that which is best, and explaining all things in detail..."} means; *We made the Book that We revealed to Musa, a complete and comprehensive Book, sufficient for what he needs to complete his Law.' Similarly, Allah said in another Ayah, 4}lr- Cs, g)jjVi 4 /I 4And We wrote for him on the Tablets the lesson to be drawn from all things.} (7:145] Allah's statement, 4fbr that which is best,} means: 'as a reward for his doing right and obeying Our commands and orders.' Allah said in other Ayat, i&tof % to 4Is there any reward for good other than what is best?>[55:60], 4\X\ o-UU&C 4» jc&& 4And (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim tried him with (certain) commands, which he fulfilled. He (Allah) said (to him), "Verily, I am going to make you an Imam for mankind."} [2:124] and, iiA-3& r. i*tr 4And We made from among them (Children of Israel), leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient and believed with certainty in Our Ayat.} (32:24] Allah said; 4and explaining all things in detail and a guidance and a mercy} praising the Book that Allah sent down to Mtisa, while,

pj \pj ipl 4...that they might believe in the meeting with their Lord. And this is a blessed Book (the Qur'an) which We have sent down, so follow it and have Taqwa so that you may receive mercy.4 This calls to following the Qur'an. Allah encourages His servants to follow His Book (the Qur'an) and orders them to understand it, adhere to it and call to it. He also describes it as being blessed, for those who follow and implement it in this life and the Hereafter, because it is the Firm Rope of Allah. ft P 111 os 'P pi-* £% ^ y\$ \$ 0* Jlf cf-i iJjij \1> tjljCjf »ji. \1&l» 4156. Lest you should say: "The Book was sent down only to two sects before us, and for our part, we were in fact unaware of what they studied."} 4157. Or lest you should say: "If only the Book had been sent down to us, we would surely have been better guided than they." So now has come unto you a clear proof from your Lord, and a guidance and a mercy. Who then does more wrong than one who rejects the Ayat of Allah and Sadafa away therefrom? We shall requite those who turn away from Our Ayat with an evil torment, because of their turning

away.} The Qur'an is Allah's Proof Against His Creation Ibn Jarir commented on the Ayah, "The Ayah means, this is a Book that We sent down, so that you do not say, 4££« & 4^fi Tl\} 4"The Book was sent down only to two sects before us."} This way, you will have no excuse. Allah said in another Ayah, C4[vi-i— VjJ J 'tyj}

527 Surah 6. Al-An'dm (157 - 158) (Part-8) a guidance and a mercy. Allah says, there has come to you from All&h a Glorious Qur'an revealed to Muhammad jgg, the Arab Prophet. In it is

the explanation of the lawful and unlawful matters, guidance for the hearts and mercy from Allah to His servants who follow and implement it. Allah said; £41% i" <? / / / •f XV* OJUtfj 4ii\ iWho then does more wrong than one who re- jects the Ayat of Allah and Sadafa away therefrom?} This refers to the one who neither benefited from what the Messenger jg brought, nor followed what he was sent with by abandoning all other ways. Rather, he Sadafa from following the Ayat of Allah, meaning, he discouraged and hindered people from following it. This is the explanation of As-Suddi for Sadafa, while Ibn 'Abbas, Muj&hid and Qatadah said that Sadafa means, he turned away from it. J Kassail jL«Sfi lit iiill (w) la w .aT 'A i 'i ti'/i'J' A *sr** *- hjbjj'ij loA (*|} 'oy£i- 4^ fJi '*%> •J»J» L>*" -Ofe ^^ >4^ i5 iljjjliu s? fe- ^4 -4 ipr OJ dZC £2g *\$% il58. Do they then waitfor anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord should come, or that

some of the Signs ofyour Lord should come! The day that some of the signs of your Lord do come, no good will it do to a person to believe then, ifhe believed not before, nor earned good with his faith. Say: "Wait you! We (too) are waiting."} The Disbelievers Await the Commencement of the Hereafter, orSome of its Portents Allah sternly threatens the disbelievers, those who defy His Messengers, deny His Ayat and hinder from His path, 4\$, t. i £» 4Do they then wait for anything other than that the angels should come to them, or that your Lord (Allah) should come...} on the Day of Resurrection, Hi£ y jz&£ 2\$ jz i} 4or that some of the signs of your Lord should come! The day that some of the signs ofyour Lord do come no good will it do to a person to believe then.} Before the commencement of the Day of Resurrection, there will come signs and portents of the Last Hour that will be witnessed by the people living at that time. In a section explaining this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, i«& if s' ifrLDl ^jjj tiThe Last Hour will not commence until the sun risesfrom the west. When the people witness that, they will all believe. This is when 4\$«xx 33 i£4ag 4no good will it do to a person to believe then, if he believed not before.}^ Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, J j£ jt ciif 1,1 Path Al-Bari 8 :147 jSS jj Lli £& i Ifr'f. b|

Ujyu* £j1L 1 IjS "Three, if they appear, then a soul will not benefit from its faith, if it had not believed before or earned good in its faith when the sun rises from the iverst, Ad-Dajjdl and the Beast of the earth. »(11 Ahmad also recorded this Hadith, and in his narration, the Prophet jg mentioned the Smoke.*2 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amr bin Jarir said, "Three Muslim men sat with Marwan in Al-Madlnah and they heard him talking about the signs (of the Last Hour). He said that the first sign will be the appearance of Ad-Dajjal. So these men went to 'Abdullah bin 'Amr and told him what they heard from Marwan about the signs. Ibn 'Amr said, Marwan said nothing. I remember that I heard the Messenger of Allah sg saying, Z\ji\ * » ! ' i - ! ' •UjS (5^^ ^Hrr'T^> Jt «The first of the signs to appear are the sun rising from the west and the Beast that appears in the early morning. Whichever comes

before the other, then the second sign will appear soon after jf."»*3 Then ‘Abdullah said - and he used to read the Scriptures - “And I think the first of them is the sun rising from the west. That is because when it sets it comes under the Throne, prostrates and seeks permission to return. So it is permitted to return until Allah wants it to rise from the west. So it does as it normally would, it comes beneath the Throne, it prostrates and seeks permission to return. But it will get no response. Then it will seek permission to return (again), but it will get no response, until what Allah wills of the night to pass goes by, and it realizes that if it is permitted to return it would not [be able to] reach the east. It says; *My Lord! The east is so far, what good would I be to [I * At-Tabari 12:265 * Ahmad 2 :445 131 Ahmad 2:201

4t\$&& H£� &h0 A saac%u&&} 4Do they then await (anything) other than the Hour, that it should come upon them suddenly? But some of its portents have already come; and when it is upon them, how can they benefit then by their reminder?} [47:18], and, <iiij jiU V* llg bjil=s»j jjwj llill £.1* jjlj UJ»> & bta ^ 4So a?/ien they saw Our punishment, they said : "We believe in Allah alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as partners." Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment.} [40:84-85] X c f# Ji Kite 4 *41X fa \&\$ kt 4159. Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, you have no concern with them in the least. Their affair is only with Allah, Who then will tell them what they used to do.} Criticizing Division in the Religion Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said that this Ayah was revealed about the Jews and Christians. 1 11 Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, X pfi} 4Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects...} “Before Muhammad ;g\$ was sent, the Jews and Christians disputed and divided into sects. When Muhammad^ was sent, Allah revealed to him, 4Verily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, At-Tabari 12:269-270

you have no concern with them in the least. 1^ It is apparent that this Ayah refers to all those who defy the religion of Allah, or revert from it. Allah sent His Messenger fg| with guidance and the religion of truth so that He makes it victorious and dominant above all religions. His Law is one and does not contain any contradiction or incongruity. Therefore, those who dispute in the religion, 4...and break up into sects,) religious sects, just like those who follow the various sects, desires and misguidance - then Allah has purified His Messenger jg from their ways. In a similar Ayah, Allah said, 4^1 Cs*j £ putf Jt (^3 4He (Allah) has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Null, and that which We have revealed to you.}[42:13] A Hadith reads, “We, the Prophets, are half brothers but have one religion. This, indeed, is the straight path which the Messengers have brought and which commands worshipping Allah alone without partners and adhering to the Law of the last Messenger jg whom Allah sent. All other paths are types of misguidance, ignorance, sheer opinion and desires; and as such, the Messengers are free from them. Allah said here, 4 pri *^1) 4You have no concern with them in the least...) [6:159]. Allah’s statement, 4&Z IX t iTheir affair is only with Allah, Who then will tell them what they used to do.) At-Tabari 12:269 ,21 Fath Al-Bari 6 :550

533Surah 6. Al-An'dm (160) (Part-8 is similar to His statement, i£C S|> 4^*^' fjJ > < -i; J-*1" iVerily, those who believe, and those who are Jews, and the Sabians, and the Christians, and the Majus, and those who worship others besides Allah; truly, Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection [22:17] Allah then mentioned His kindness in His decisions and His justice on the Day of

Resurrection, when He said. * £ •ii t&k *m& it \$0 jii % ;t& 4 1'i\0>l)Lku il60. Whoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit, and whoever brings an evil deed shall have only the recompense of the like thereof, and they will not be wronged The Good Deed is Multiplied Tenfold, While the Sin is Recompensed with the Same This Ayah explains the general Ayah ^Whoever comes with good, then he will receive better than that>[28:84] There are several Hadiths that are in agreement with the apparent wording of this honorable Ayah. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said about his Lord, IfL* jji J sL^S I+Uju ~pJ> ji (> jliSj oj d^ i^i Ji-a ;'jiS JI J <--~A VI <3jI l.fj 'jj A" ***' j\ 3JL*-Ij J C--~^ i iLls- ajuii 11Your Lord is Most Merciful. Whoever intends to perform a good deed and does not do it, it will be written for him as a good deed. If he performs it, it will be written for him as ten

reward. The reason being that, this person did not intend to do good, nor commit evil. Some people abandon the sin because they were unable to commit it or due to laziness, after trying to commit it and seeking the means that help commit it. This person is just like the person who commits the sin. There is an authentic Hadith that states, «j&ij j jjuii iij» *When two Muslims meet with their swords, then the killer and the killed will be in the Fire. They said, "O Allah's Messenger! We know about the killer, so what about the killed?" He said, jii iSa,ji- o\S iij» «He was eager to kill his companion .j* 11 Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim Af-Tabarani said that Abu Malik Al- Ash'ari said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. at oS/ Alls lfd£% 1stijj ty; ,J\ ii^Ji i&; uj ij\ls ji;% && : Jli •Friday (prayer) to the next Friday (preayer), plus three more days, erase whatever was committed (of sins) between them. This is because Allah says: Whoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit*™ Abu Dharr narrated that the Messenger of Allah said, «lis 'jijS1 fLi aS 'js Ji fd i-%fU -ft •1Whoever fasts three days every month, will have fasted all the time. Ahmad, An-Nasal, and Ibn Majah recorded this Hadith, and this is Ahmad's wording. At-Tirmidhi also recorded it with this addition; ^ dJUi -dJI Jpti» •So Allah sent down affirmation of this statement in His Book, 111 Al-Bukhari, nos. 31 , 6875 and 7083 ' At-Tabarani 3 :298

4000 % 0±i K *} iWhoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit, < c 31" «Therefore, a day earns ten days .» At-Tirmidhi said; "This Hadith is Hasan".! ' There are many other Hadiths and statements on this subject, but what we mentioned should be sufficient, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. in 0 Si tlli tLj jj ..: Jp i£Uj» ^11 v -jar^ ^ \$ ti; i>1 <162. Say; "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, Hanifan (monotheism) and he was not of the Mushrikin."} 4162. Say: "Verily , my Saldh, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying arefor Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} 4163. "He has no partner. And of this I have been commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims."} Islam is the Straight Path Allah commands His Prophet 5g, the chief of the Messengers, to convey the news of being guided to Allah's straight path. This path is neither wicked, nor deviant, 4£j &>} 4a right religion...} that is, established on firm grounds, V? tijU0 %} 4The religion of Ibrahim, Hanifan and he was not of the Mushrikin .} Allah said in similar Ayat, 40* '0 o* Si o* — 0j} Ahmad 5:146, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:470, An-Nasal 4:218 and Ibn Majah 1 :545

iAtid who turns away from the religion of Ibrahim except him who deludes himseip> [2:130], and, 'M ij*- 4 4And strive hard in Allah's cause as you ought to strive. He has chosen you, and has not laid upon

you in religion any hardship: it is the religion of your father Ibrahim.} [22:78], and, ISfTS L&j S*^ 4*-
 rt ^ 3 AX—> LijJl J A-ij '*_) i* i ty li-X*- JL— iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah (or a nation), obedient
 to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the Mushrikin . (He was) thankfUl for His (Allah's) favors. He
 (Allah) chose him (as an intimate friend) and guided him to a straight path. And We gave him good in
 this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous. Then, We have sent the revelation to you
 (saying): "Follow the religion of Ibrahim, (he was a) Hanif, and he was not of the Mushrikin"}
 [16:120-123]. Ordering the Prophet sjg to follow the religion of Ibrahim, the HanifiyyahJ does not
 mean that Prophet Ibrahim reached more perfection in it than our Prophet jg. Rather, our Prophet
 perfectly established the religion and it was completed for him; and none before him reached this level
 of perfection. This is why he is the Final Prophet, the chief of all the Children of Adam who holds the
 station of praise and glory, the honor of intercession on the Day of Resurrection. All creation (on that
 Day) will seek him, even Ibrahim the friend of Allah, peace be upon him [to request the beginning
 ofJudgement]. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Messenger of Allah was asked,
 'Which religion is the best with Allah, the Exalted?' He said, m See the Tafsir of SuratAl-Baqarah no .
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Al-Hanifiyyah As-Samhah (the easy monotheism)^ TheCommand for Sincerity in Worship Allah
 said next, il>l iSay: "Verily, my Salah, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying arefor Allah, the Lord
 ofthe all that exists."} Allah commands the Prophet sg to inform the idolaters who worship other than
 Allah and sacrifice to something other than Him, that he opposes them in all this, for his prayer is for
 Allah, and his rituals are in His Name alone, without partners. Allah said in a similar statement,
 iTherejbre turn in prayer to your Lord and sacrifice.} [108:2], meaning, make your prayer and sacrifice
 for Allah alone. As for the idolaters, they used to worship the idols and sacrifice to them, so Allah
 commanded the Prophet to defy them and contradict their practices. Allah, the Exalted, commanded
 him to dedicate his intention and heart to being sincere for Him alone. Mujahid commented, iVerily, my
 prayer and my Nusuk...} refers to sacrificing during Hajj and 'Umrah. Islam Is the Religion ofall
 Prophets The Ayah, Si%} iand I am thefirst of the Muslims.} means, from this Ummah, according to
 Qatadah.¹²¹ This is a sound meaning, because all Prophets before our Prophet jg were calling to Islam,'
 which commands worshipping Allah alone without partners. Allah said in another Ayah, Ahmad 1 :236
 At-Tabari 12:285

ft vi 4And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the
 right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me."} [21:25) Allah informed us that Nuh said to his people,
 <>, 5* £ ^& 4' P »^ & jSiJ 4K 4Bui i/yow turn away, then no reward have I asked ofyou, my reward is
 onlyfrom Allah, and I have been commanded to be of the Muslims.} [10:72] Allah said, <4 tty.j <4 X&j
 jLlii ii-i ,>* *^1 J*' tn. i*« y} cJd 3tt Jd 2 tf il ^ di VJ V* C\$3' <i' 6] Z£~i trf. 4And who turns away
 from the religion of Ibrahim except him who deludes himself? Truly, We chose him in this world and
 verily, in the Hereafter he will be among the righteous. When his Lord said to him, "Submit (i.e. be a
 Muslim)!" He said, "I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of the all that exists." And this
 was enjoined by Ibrahim upon his sons and by Ya'qub (saying), "O my sons! Allah has chosen for you
 the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslitsn."^(2:130-132]. YQsuf, peace be upon liUtl) W«UVI|
 A ^ 4111 ^ . i£s is- J* yj Z*% gif H 4My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty,
 and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the

earth! You are my Wali (Protector) in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim, and join me with the righteous.} [12:101] MQsS said, \£y yui y* Oi. 'jl? oj fy i try 3*jj}

alone without partners, even though the laws which are like the different mothers in this parable, are different. Allah the Most High knows best. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali said that when the Messenger of Allah jg used to start the prayer with Takbir [saying, “Allahu Akbati” (Allah is the Great)] he would then supplicate, Ir! ^ 1 ol^JJI 'Jai ^jJj 'r'J J*> J'&'j «/ have directed my face towards He Who has created the heavens and earth, Hanifan and I am not among the Mushriktn. Certainly, my prayer, sacrifice, living and dying are allfor Allah, Lord of the worlds .» o« ,U> ilxi- ojl iC-ji V] ill V JILJI iOif VI <LijjSl\ 'jiiu V U->>- i V['-fV" ,_*-* V ic-jf VJ L^I>-S[V «id| 4^/fj “O Allah! You are the King, there is no deity worthy of worship except You. You are my Lord and I am Your servant. I have committed wrong against myself and admitted to my error, so forgive me all my sins. Verily, You, only You forgive the sins. (O Allah!) Direct me to the best conduct, for none except You directs to the best conduct. Divert me from the worst conduct, for only You divert from the worst conduct. Glorified and Exalted You are. I seek Your forgiveness and repent to You. n* 1 This Hadith, which was also recorded by Muslim in the Sahib,*21 continues and mentions the Prophet’s supplication in his bowing, prostrating and final sitting positions. •ji'j s) 'ij 'tffo V' u-i< j^=> v-iS Vj if i>j fij fj jf jl* jf **** Ahmad 1 :102 Muslim 1 :534

543Surah 6. Al-An'am (164) (Part-8) iLord of the east and the west; none has the right to be worshipped but He. So take Him a guardian.} (73:9) There are similar Ayat on this subject. Every Person Carries HisOwn Burden Allah said. 4No person earns any (sin) except against himself (only), and no bearer ofburdens shall bear the burden ofanother.} thus emphasizing Allah’s reckoning, decision and justice that will occur on the Day of Resurrection. The souls will only be recompensed for their deeds, good for good and evil for evil. No person shall carry the burden of another person, a fact that indicates Allah’s perfect justice. Allah said in other Ayat, ii ; 4And if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin.} (35: 18], and. 4CZ% CS£4%\$} iThen he will have no fear of injustice, nor ofany curtailment (ofhis reward).} (20:112) Scholars of Tafsir commented, “No person will be wronged by canying the evil deeds of another person, nor will his own good deeds be curtailed or decreased.” Allah also said; 4Every person is a pledge for what he has earned. Except those on the Right.} (74:38-39), meaning, every person will be tied to his evil deeds. But, for those on the right - the believers - the blessing of their good works will benefit their offspring and relatives, as well. Allah said in Surat At-Tur, m>> (•£ 'I •‘YA.Y . tf 4*# !>-.•* U-.'M 4And those who believe and whose offspring follow them in

faith, to them shall We join their offspring, and We shall not decrease the reward of their deeds in anything.} {52:2 1], meaning, We shall elevate their offspring to their high grades in Paradise, even though the deeds of the offspring were less righteous, since they shared faith with them in its general form. Allah says, We did not decrease the grades of these righteous believers so that those (their offspring and relatives) who have lesser grades, can share the same grades as them. Rather Allah elevated the lesser believers to the grades of their parents by the blessing of their parents’ good works, by His favor and bounty. Allah said next (in Surat At-Tur), lx £} i^Every person is a pledge for that which he has earned.} [52:21], meaning, of evil. Allah’s statement here, iThen unto your Lord is your

return, so He will tell you that wherein you have been differing.} means, work you (disbelievers), and we will also work. Surely, both you and us will be gathered to Allah and He will inform us of our deeds and your deeds and the decision on what we used to dispute about in the life of this world. Allah said in other Ayat, £2 2% G: £2 » IU %&& T52&& y iSay: "You will not be asked about our sins, nor shall we be asked of what you do." Say: "Our Lord will assemble us all together, then He will judge between us with truth. And He is the Just Judge, the All-Knower of the true state of affairs."} [34:25-26]. 4 'V '^3 yliJI <&j 6) 4165. And it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth. And He has

raised you in ranks , some above others that He may try you in that which He has bestowed on you. Surely, your Lord is Sioift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Allah Made Mankind Dwellers on the earth, Generation After Generation, of Various Grades, in order to Test Them Allah said, 4cfJ^^ pksdlur £j} 4And it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth.} meaning, He made you dwell on the earth generation after generation, century after century and offspring after forefathers, according to Ibn Zayd and others. Allah also said, 4:"pj3Z. Jfsii 4 £* &L S3 %} 4And if it were Our will. We would have made angels to replace you on the earth [43:60], and, 4j£i^ &3L 4And makes you inheritors of the Earth, getteratiotis after generations.} [27:62], and 4Verily, I am going to place (mankind) generations after generations on earth.} [2:30], and. V, 4 iJ Cr-^} 4It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you act.} [7:129] Allah's statement, y /// *' */ (*-***! (hi? 4And He has raised you in ranks, some above others,}

546 TafsTr Ibn Kathir means. He has made you different from each other with regards to provision, conduct, qualities, evilness, shapes, color of skin, and so forth, and He has the perfect wisdom in all this. Allah said in other Ayat, L&? jy£«i ilt is We Who portion out between them their livelihood in this world, and We raised some of them above others in ranks, so that some may employ others in their work.} [43:32], and, @^i-**** j\$1> y-i-Ji 'jf&i Jf*i& (>£• > LJyi JjS Jlity iSee how We prefer one above another (in this world), and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} (17:21] Allah's statement, ithat He may try you in that which He has bestowed on you.} means, so that He tests you in what He has granted you, for Allah tries the rich concerning his wealth and will ask him about how he appreciated it. He also tries the poor concerning his poverty and will ask him about his patience with it. Muslim recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah said, iijjJi \jaj\i i iL) nu ijj 2)i ojj o UjjJi jji i.idlij few. te& W •Verily, this life is beautiful and green, and Allah made you dwell in it generation after generation so that He sees what you will do. Therefore, beware of this life and beware ofwomen, for the first trial that the Children of Israel sufferedfrom was with women. >,1] Allah's statement. m Muslim 4:2098

iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} this is both discouragement and encouragement, by reminding the believers that Allah is swift in reckoning and punishment with those who disobey Him and defy His Messengers, 4^5 33%} 4And certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} for those who take Him as protector and follow His Messengers in the news and commandments they conveyed. Allah often mentions these two attributes together in the Qur'an. Allah said, 4-^UJt JjJ-J i)\f) j* oM. b-i~M b\j} 4But verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for

mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment} [13:6], and. iDeclare untoMy servants, that truly, I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} [15:49-50] There are similar Ayat that contain encouragement and discouragement. Sometimes Allah calls His servants to Him with encouragement, describing Paradise and making them eager for what He has with Him. Sometimes, He calls His servants with discouragement, mentioning the Fire and its torment and punishment, as well as, the Day of Resurrection and its horrors. Sometimes Allah mentions both so that each person is affected by it according to his or her qualities. We ask Allah that He makes us among those who obey what He has commanded, avoid what He has prohibited, and believe in Him as He has informed. Certainly, He is Near, hears and answers the supplication, and He is the Most Kind, Generous and Bestowing. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{U pUL; j /jJ-\wedge \text{ oIp U jl pJC}}$

$\text{Zj-J oJL>-lj j 4j\> 4Ul jJL^ k^L^dl JL>-f ialj L}\text{ 4a>-^J l 4jj I XjP m ' Ij <ul jlp_j Ljj <aL>- «//}$ Me believer knew Allah's punishment, no one will hope in entering His Paradise. And if the disbeliever knew Allah's mercy, no one will feel hopeless of acquiring Paradise. Allah created a hundred kinds of mercy. He sent down one of them to His creation, and they are merciful to each other on that account. With Allah, there remains ninety-nine kinds of merci/. Muslim and At-Tirmidhi also recorded this Hadlth, At- Tirmidhi said “Hasan”. Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{.*J I (\text{ } y \&\text{£jr yXi <—> \text{ls <ul jU- UJ V ' ' ' / * " «When Allah created the creation, He wrote in a Book, and this Book is with Him above the Throne : 'My mercy overcomes My anger.'v}^{\text{TM}}}$

Surah 7: Al-Araf

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 1888]

Opening The Tafslrof Surat Al-A'raf (Chapter - 7)

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1888–1900]

' • >*< '1 */ Ji1-i ^ iAj3' isPi'i \pp % %, « Ej'i\$ u ii vu; h)\ I*/ , j. 41 . Alif-Lam-Mim-Sad 42. (This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down unto you, so let not your breast be narrow there- from, that you warn thereby; and a reminder unto the believers.} 43 . Follow what has been sent down unto youfrom your Lord, andfallow not any Awliya' (protectors), besides Him (Allah). Lit- tle do you remember!} We mentioned before the explanation of the letters [such as, Alif-Lam, that are in the beginning of some Surahs in the Qur'an). i<%i '4&¥ Jr \# 5z%» gf e\$m A. jLLj b4>Litlsi 06Mi&x Ccy.;\$»*«oKtj\$ j | Cp<£*\$» 0 0^\ * 1)jo.a_^-jj'y*oxai,j*i \ ^ f>-r

i(This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down unto you (O Muhammad)}, from your Lord, 4*4 A&^ iso let not your breast be narrow therefrom,} meaning, having doubt about it according to Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi. It was also said that the meaning here is: 'do not hesitate to convey the Qur'an and warn with it,' o* ^ cr^} iTherefore be patient as did the Messengers ofstrong will} [46:35). Allah said here, ithat you warn thereby meaning, We sent down the Qur'an so that you may warn the disbelievers with it,' 43s*» iand a reminder unto the believers}. Allah then said to the world, 4& iFollow what has been sent down unto youfrom your Lord} meaning, follow and imitate the unlettered Prophet j\$, who brought you a Book that was revealed for you, from the Lord and master of everything. 4*0\$ ji lAr iandfollow not any Awliya', besides Him (Allah)} meaning, do not disregard what the Messenger brought you and follow something else, for in this case, you will be deviating from Allah's judgment to the decision of someone else. Allah's statement, iLittle do you remember!} is similar to. m At-Tabari 12 :296

4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly}[12: 103] , and; JgH"—l Cy 4And ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far awayfrom Allah's path}[6:116], and, cyji «3> 4And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him}[12: 106] & \ & a el: && «£& & A 9\$ c5% til 44. And a great number of towns Wc destroyed. Our torment came upon them by night or while they were taking their midday nap.} 45 . No cry did they utter when Our torment came upon them but this: "Verily, we were wrongdoers."} 46. Then surely, We shall question those (people) to whom it was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers.} 47. Then surely, We

shall narrate unto them (their whole story) with knowledge, and indeed We have not been absent.} Nations that were destroyed Allah said. ji \$>} 4And a great number oftowns We destroyed.} for defying Our Messengers and rejecting them. This behavior led them to earn disgrace in this life, which led them to disgrace in the Hereafter. Allah said in other Ayat, ly^=* I ssjjtif jSsj} 4And indeed (many) Messengers before you were mocked at.

but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at} (6:10], and Jt iAnd many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins (up to this day), and (many) a deserted well and lofty castle!} [22:45], and. {And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankless for its means of livelihood And those are their dwellings, which have not been inlwbited after them except a little. And verily, We have been the /ieirs>[28:58]. Allah's saying, (U i%et&} {Our torment came upon them by night or while they were taking their midday nap.} means, Allah's command, torment and vengeance came over them at night or while taking a nap in the middle of the day. Both of these times are periods of rest and leisure or heedlessness and amusement. Allah also said J &s\ jit ^t ji <£. et j j^ ^Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?}[7:97-98] and, s-krTff _)* Jrj 4 >7Vs j* >-»4 jt !*• 4 J* i 'v'L rj 4Do then those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allah will

not sink than into the earth, or that the torment will not seize than from directions they perceive not? Or that He may catch them in the midst of their going to and from, so that there be no escape for them? Or that He may catch them with gradual wastage. Truly, Your Lord is indeed full of kindness, Most Merciful?) [16:45-47]. Allah's saying; &A %£ A pii ij of 4No cry did they utter when Our torment came upon than but this: "Verily, we were wrongdoers.") This means, when the torment came to them, their ciy was that they admitted their sins and that they deserved to be punished. Allah said in a similar Ayat, cJi f-tj £jj) iHow many a town given to wrongdoing, have We destroyed)[2 1:11], until, 4Extinct) [21:15]. Allah's saying. 4x4 ' xl4 > 4Thai surely. We shall question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent is similar to the Ayat, 4And (remember) the Day (Allah) will call them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers?" [28:65], and, SJ u% y ijsX4 EC 4A2 jijif lit yx>_) 40n the Day what Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them "What was the response you received?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, verily, only You are the Knower ofall that is unseen.") [5:109]. Allah will question the nations, on the Day of Resurrection, how they responded to His Messengers and the Messages He sent them with. He will also question the Messengers if they conveyed His Messages. So, 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from

Ibn 'Abbas, who said commenting on the Ayat iTheti surely, We shall question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers. He said; "About what they conveyed." Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, iThen surely, We shall narrate unto them (their whole story) with knowledge, and indeed We have not been absent "The Book'21 will be brought forth on the Day of Resurrection and it will speak, disclosing what they used to do." |3 ' &&& iand indeed We have not been absent£ meaning, On the Day of Resurrection, Allah will inform His servants about what they said and did, whether substantial or minor. Certainly, He witnesses to everything, nothing

escapes His observation, and He is never unaware of anything. Rather, He has perfect knowledge of what the eyes are deluded by and what the hearts conceal, iNot a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.^[6:59] +8. And the weighing on that Day will be the true (weighing). So, as far those whose scale (of good deeds) will be heavy, they will be the successful (by entering Paradise).} 111 At-Tabari 12:306. ' The Book . See SuratAl-Kahf 18 :49 131 At-Tabari 12:308.

i9. And as for those whose scale will be light, they are those who will lose themselves for their wrongful behavior with Our Aydt.} The Meaning of weighing the Deeds Allah said, iAnd the weighing of deeds on the Day of Resurrection, iwill be the true (weighing)}, for Allah will not wrong anyone. Allah said in other Ayat, oi f- iAnd We shall set up the Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed, We will bring it. And Sufficient are We to take account.}[2VA7], l/r' oi iSurely, Allah wrongs not even the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good (done). He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward.} [4:40), ft ©Xyy SIS is Ci& E; &S iThen as for him whose scale (of good deeds) will be heavy. He will live a pleasant life (in Paradise). But as for him whose scale (of good deeds) will be light. He will have his home in Hawiyah (pit. Hell). And what will make you know what it is? (It is) a fiercely blazing Fire!} [101:6-11) and,

{Then, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another. Then, those whose scales (of good deeds) are heavy, they are the successful. And those whose scales (of good deeds) are light, they are those who lose themselves, in Hell will they abide23:101-103). As for what will be placed on the Balance on the Day of Resurrection, it has been said that the deeds will be placed on it, even though they are not material objects. Allah will give these deeds physical weight on the Day of Resurrection. Al- Baghawi said that this was reported from Ibn 'Abbas. 111 It is recorded in the Sahib that Al-Baqarah (chapter 2) and Al 'Imran (chapter 3) will come on the Day of Resurrection in the shape of two clouds, or two objects that provide shade, or two lined groups of birds. 121 It is also recorded in the Sahth that the Qur'an will come to its companion (who used to recite and preserve it) in the shape of a pale-faced young man. He will ask (the young man), "Who are you?" He will reply, "I am the Qur'an, who made you stay up sleeplessly at night and caused you thirst in the day." 131 The Hadith that Al-Bara' narrated about the questioning in the grave states. IUULip tlf :J^£» if '-djQ gifa ir-*" ifW^ "A young man with fair color and good scent will come to the believer, who will ask, 'Who are you?' He will reply, 'I am your good deeds'®. The Prophet ^ mentioned the opposite in the case of the disbeliever and the hypocrite. It was also said that the Book of Records that contains the deeds will be weighed. A Hadith states that a man will be brought forth and ninety-nine scrolls containing errors and sins will be placed on one side of the balance each as long as the sight can reach. He will then be brought a card on which 111 Al-Baghawi 2:149. 121 Muslim 1 :553. 131 Ibn Majah 2:1242. 141 Ahmad 4 :287

25Surah 7. Al-A'raf (8 - 9) (Part-8) 'La ilaha illallah' will be written. He will say, "O Lord! What would this card weigh against these scrolls?" Allah will say, "You will not be wronged." So the card will be placed on the other side of the Balance, and as the Messenger of Allah ^ said, (UiiLji oii ; c-tiLii «Behold! The (ninety-nine) scrolls will go up, as the card becomes heavier .»(11 At-Tirmidhi recorded

similar wording for this Hadith and said that it is authentic. It was also said that the person who performed the deed will be weighed. A Hadith states. -Mp Oj “On the Day of Resurrection, a fat man will be brought forth, but he will not weigh with Allah equal to the wing of a mosquito». He then recited the Ayah, 4& fj? 4And on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them} [18:105]/ Also, the Prophet said about ‘Abdullah bin Mas'Qd, be J^ ^ LJJ ;Jl w ja “Do you wonder at the thinness of his legs? By He in Wlwse Hand is my soul! They are heavier on the Balance than (Moutit) Uhud.»M It is also possible to combine the meanings of these Ayat and Hadiths by stating that all this wall truly occur, for sometimes the deeds wall be weighed, sometimes the scrolls where they are recorded wall be weighed, and sometimes those who performed the deeds wall be weighed. Allah knows best. U ">Ui JjfZ. ijf Jffj\ j Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :395 [2 ' Fath Al-Bari 8 :279 131 Ahmad 1 :420

410. And surely. We gave you authority on the earth and appointed for you therein livelihoods. Little thanks do you give-} All Bounties in the Heavens and Earth are for the Benefit ofMankind Allah reminds of His favor on His servants in that He made the earth a fixed place for dwelling, placed firm mountains and rivers on it and made homes and allowed them to utilize its benefits. Allah made the clouds work for them (bringing rain) so that they may produce their sustenance from them. He also created the ways and means of earnings, commercial activities and other professions. Yet, most of them give litle thanks for this. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And ifyou count the blessings ofAllah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed a wrongdoer, an ingrate.} [14:34] js j) f'4 WWt f p*c!Z zsj} OS 411. And surely, We created you and then gave you shape; then We told the angels, “Prostrate yourselves to Adam," and they prostrated, except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused to be of those who prostrated.} Prostration of the Angels to Adam and Shaytan’s Arrogance Allah informs the Children ofAdam about the honor of their father and the enmity of Shaytan, who still has envy for them and for their father Adam. So they should beware of him and not follow in his footsteps. Allah said, a '{ -JZj} 4And surely, We created you and then gaveyou shape ; then We told the angels, Prostrate yourselves to Adam,” and they prostrated,}

27Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (10 -11) (Part-8) Jr (SJaiiss \ox (223\$ p4*r-o?j p^j^froVliSf cPbj*^Eji*jul^;jrp du3££ln& 6^mj3 C%1 \ This is like His saying, ^li- i^LM dCj JB ^ £ <p£ * £3 %t^ >Jb& j; \$And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "I am going to create a man from dried (sounding) clay of al- tered mud. So, when I have fashioned him com- pletely and breathed into him the soul (which I created for him), then fall (you) down prostrat- ing yourselves unto him."} |15:28-29). After Allah created Adam with His Hands from dried clay of altered mud and made him in the shape of a human being, He blew life into him and ordered the angels to prostrate before him, honoring Allah’s glory and magnificence. The angels all heard, obeyed and prostrated, but Iblis did not prostrate. We explained this subject in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. Therefore, the Ayah (7:11) refers to Adam, although Allah used the plural in this case, because Adam is the father of all mankind. Similarly, Allah said to the Children of Israel who lived during the time of the Prophet ig, j££ tfjj ' fOi(iAnd We shaded you with clouds and sent down on you manna and the quail,}[2:57] This refers to their forefathers who lived during the time of

28 Tafsir Ibri Kathir Moses. But, since that was a favor given to the forefathers, and they are their very source, then the offspring have also been favored by it. This is not the case in: 4And indeed We created

man out of an extract of clay (water and earth.))[23:12\ For this merely means that Adam was created from clay. His children were created from Nutfah (mixed male and female sexual discharge). This last Ayah is thus talking about the origin of mankind, not that they were all created from clay, and Allah knows best. 4; ££.; yd * S 3.U& ft} 412. (Allah) said: "What prevented you (O Iblis) that you did not prostrate, when I commanded you?" Iblis said: "I am better than him (Adam), You created me from fire, and him You created from clay."} Allah said, iWhat prevented you (O Iblis) that you did not prostrate} (7:12) meaning, what stopped and hindered you from prostrating after I ordered you to do so, according to Ibn Jarir. This meaning is sound, and Allah knows best. Iblis, may Allah curse him, said, 4/ am better than him (Adam)}, and this excuse is worse than the crime itself! Shaytan said that he did not obey Allah because he who is better cannot prostrate to he who is less. Shaytan, may Allah curse him, meant that he is better than Adam, "So how can You order me to prostrate before him?" Shaytan said that he is better than Adam because-he was created from fire while, "You created him from clay, and fire is better." The cursed one looked at the origin of creation not at the honor bestowed, that is, Allah creating Adam with His Hand and blowing life into him. Shaytan made a false comparison when confronted by Allah's command,

4"Then you fall down prostrate to /ii'm">[38:72]. Therefore, Shaytan alone contradicted the angels, because he refused to prostrate. He, thus, became 'Ablasa' from the mercy, meaning, lost hope in acquiring Allah's mercy. He committed this error, may Allah curse him, due to his false comparison. His claim that the fire is more honored than mud was also false, because mud has the qualities of wisdom, for - bearance, patience and assurance, mud is where plants grow, flourish, increase, and provide good. To the contrary, fire has

the qualities of burning, recklessness and hastiness. Therefore,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1900–1912]

the origin of creation directed Shaytan to failure, while the origin of Adam led him to return to Allah with repentance, humbleness, obedience and submission to His command, admitting his error and seeking Allah's forgiveness and pardon for it. Muslim recorded that 'Aishah said that the Messenger of Allah said, "The angels were created from light, Shaytan from a smokeless flame offire, while Adam was created from what was described to you».(11 Iblis was the First to use Qiyas (Analogical Comparison) Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Hasan commented on Shaytan's statement, Ji is; 4"You created me from fire, and him You created from clay."} "Iblis used Qiyas (analogy], and he was the first one to do so."*21 This statement has an authentic chain of narration. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Sirin said, "The first to use Qiyas was Iblis, and would the sun and moon be worshipped if it was not 111 Muslim 4 :2294 •2| At-Tabari 12:328.

for Qiyas?'*1] This statement also has an authentic chain of narration. Jl JU U J is&£& JUS &> <13. (Allah) said : "(O Mis) get down from this (Paradise), it is not for you to be arrogant here. Get out, for you are of those humiliated and disgraced."} <14. (Mis) said: "Allow me respite till the Day they are raised up (the Day of Resurrection)."} <15. (Allah) said: "You are of those respited."} Allah ordered Iblis; <<?»W <Get down yrom this} "because you defied My command and disobeyed Me. Get out, it is not for you to be arrogant here," in Paradise, according to the scholars of Tafsir. It could also refer to

particular status which he held in the utmost highs. Allah said to Iblis, m *si»l <Gef out, for you are of those humiliated and disgraced.} as just recompense for his ill intentions, by giving him the opposite of what he intended (arrogance). This is when the cursed one remembered and asked for respite until the Day of Judgment, iThen allow me respite till the Day they are raised up. (Allah) said: "Then you are of those respited."} (15: 36-37] Allah gave Shaytan what he asked for out of His wisdom, being His decision and decree, that is never prevented or resisted. Surely, none can avert His decision, and He is swift in reckoning. [i] j*> Ift if?, o; p ijiV ^ &S14* rt# At-Tabari 12:328.

31Surah 7. Al-A'raf (16 - 17) (Part-8) 116. (Iblis) said: "Because You have 'Aghwaytni', surely, I will sit in wait against them (human beings) on Your straight path 117. "Then I will come to them from before them and behind them, from their right and from their left, and You will not find most of them to be thankful."} Allah said that after He gave respite to Shaytan, itill the Day they are raised up (resurrected)} and Iblis was sure that he got what he wanted, he went on in defiance and rebellion. He said, i'fdpx p 528 ts} i"Because You have 'Aghwaytani', surely, I will sit in wait against them (human beings) on Your straight path."} meaning, as You have sent me astray. Ibn 'Abbas said that 'Aghwaytani means, "Misguided me." 111 Others said, "As You caused my ruin, I will sit in wait for Your servants whom You will create from the offspring of the one you expelled me for." He went on, iYour straight path}, the path of truth and the way of safety. I (Iblis) will misguide them from this path so that they do not worship You Alone, because You sent me astray. Mujahid said that the 'straight path', refers to the truth. Imam Ahmad recorded that Saburah bin Abi Al-Fakih said that he heard the Messenger of Allah \$*§ saying, (i) jijj «1—jt : Jlii 4J jSjti •jY'y jj»a .MU* »ll :Jlii d ^ iUiui :Jli Jtij Jlj oLkii u)jU\ J** Ujlj iJUlj Jlj Jjfeu <J JUJ IS 4il JISj sL^ui : Jtf tJUJl fZJ&j of^Ul ^Sc3 J* I**- Ja i>[) lifJl il jiil (JU U>- &\£ toll! JjLJj Jii At-Tabari 12:332.

2IS iiiiSj jf 2>Jl of <iil ,JU ll»- oi£ o\j i2>Jl iiU-ju of «3»l «2>ji iLj-jJ of «&i ,jji- u>- ois «Shaytan sat in wait for the Son of Adam in all his paths. He sat in the path of Islam, saying, "Would you embrace Islam and abandon your religion and the religion of your forefathers?" However, the Son of Adam disobeyed Shaytdn and embraced Islam. So Shaytdn sat in the path of Hijrah (migration in the cause of Allah), saying, Would you migrate and leave your land and sky?' But the parable of the Muhdjir is that of a horse in his stamina So, he disobeyed Shaytdn and migrated. So Shaytdn sat in the path of jihad, against one's self and with his wealth, saying, 'If you fight, you will be killed, your wife will be married and your wealth divided.' So he disobeyed him and performed jihad. Therefore, whoever among them (Children of Adam) does this and dies, it ivill be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. Ifhe is killed, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. If he drowns, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. If the animal breaks his neck, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise ."[11 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on: 'f) iThen I will come to them from before them) Raising doubts in them concerning their Hereafter, iand (from) behind them), making them more eager for this life, &) ifrom their right), causing them confusion in the religion, iand from their left) luring them to commit sins." 121 This is meant to cover all paths of good and evil. Shaytan Ahmad 3:483. |2) At-Jabari 12:338.

discourages the people from the path of good and lures them to the path of evil. Al-Hakam bin Abban said that 'Ikrimah narrated from Ibn 'Abbas concerning the Ayah, iThett I will come to them from

37 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (21 - 23) (Part-8 lest it should shake with you ;} [16:15] that is, so that the earth does not shake with you. iAttd he Qdsamahuma}, swore to them both by Allah, saying, 'Jo d3 4"Verily, I am one of the sincere well-wishers for you both."} for I was here before you and thus have better knowledge of this place. It is a fact that the believer in Allah might sometimes become the victim of deceit. Qatadah commented on this Ayah, "Shaytan swore by Allah, saying, 1 was created before you, and I have better knowledge than you. Therefore, follow me and I will direct you." LTiCf Tor mm V, 7M <•: 't f/si'.ilJO' OjjJ 4julo-l>U IjLjiililj (1)y-jj* iftjj.«Uji?1?V•*" " *s_ ?, **\> -S' ' -if ""-I X , '<, 1! t'if>**.!:< -S y " J 1 tSJUfc MCLtfju_g-4 jJJ-302*Uj jjj os UilS C-'J kA SZ \f&\ (ft Ui ii :f:^& c23 o^iiT Si tscj its &sit c£b ^ OJ U i o\j C^jit Uilk vl2j 422. So he misled them with deception. Then when they tasted of the tree, that which was hidden from them of their shame (private parts) became manifest to them and they began to cover themselves with the leaves of Paradise. And their Lord called out to them (saying): "Did I not forbid you that tree and tell you : Verily, Shaytan is an open enemy unto you?"}

38 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 423. They said: "Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers."} Ubayy bin Kab said, "Adam was a tall man, about the height of a palm tree, and he had thick hair on his head. When he committed the error that he committed, his private part appeared to him while before, he did not see it. So he started running in fright through Paradise, but a tree in Paradise took him by the head. He said to it, 'Release me,' but it said, "No, I will not release you.' So his Lord called him, 'O Adam! Do you run away from Me?' He said, 'O Lord! I felt ashamed before You.'"} Ibn Jarir and Ibn Marduyah collected this statement using several chains of narration from Al-Hasan from Ubayy bin Kab who narrated it from the Prophet jg. 121 However, relating the Hadith to Ubayy is more correct. Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, 40\$ Oi '-pie 4And they began to cover themselves with the leaves of Paradise.} "Using fig leaves."131 This statement has an authentic chain of narration leading to Ibn 'Abbas. Mujahid said that they began to cover themselves with the leaves of Paradise, "Making them as a dress (or garment)."141 Commenting on Allah's statement, 4&Q& iStripping them of their raiment} [7:27] Wahb bin Munabbih said, "The private parts of Adam and Hawwa' had a light covering them which prevented them from seeing the private parts of each other. When they ate from the tree, their private parts appeared to them." Ibn Jarir reported this statement with an authentic chain of narration.151 Abdur-Razzaq reported from Qatadah, "Adam said, 'O Lord! 111 At-Tabari 12:354. 121 At-Tabari 12:352. At-Tabari 12:354. At-Tabari 12:353. 151 At-Tabari 12:355.

39 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (24 - 25) (Part-8 What if I repented and sought forgiveness?' Allah said, Then, I will admit you into Paradise.' As for Shaytan, he did not ask for forgiveness, but for respite. Each one of them was given what he asked for." * Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim commented, Oi U jv* jl jjj Ciil Ul* ilj} 4"Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers."} "These are the words that Adam received from his Lord."*2 S? fe 4&& V5J Wrp 424. (Allah) said: "Get down, one of you an enemy to the other. On earth will be a dwelling place for you and an enjoymentfor a time."} 425. He said: "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, andfrom it you shall be brought out (resurrected)."} SendingThem AllDown to Barth It was said that, <iV» 4Get down}, was addressed to Adam, Hawwa', Iblis and the snake. Some scholars did not mention the snake, and Allah knows best. The enmity is primarily betweenAdam and Iblis, and

Hawwa' follows Adam in this regard. Allah said in Surah TaHa, 4 "Get you down (from the Paradise to the earth), both of you, together..." [20:123]. If the story about the snake is true, then it is a follower of Iblis. Some scholars mentioned the location on earth they were sent down, but these accounts are taken from the Israelite tales, and only Allah knows if they are true. If having known these areas was useful for the people in matters of religion or 1 1 'Abdur-Razz&q 2 :226 . See Surat Al-Baqarah 2 :37 121 At-Tabari 12:357.

life, Allah would have mentioned them in His Book, and His Messenger would have mentioned them too. Allah's statement. iOti earth will be a dwelling place for you and an enjoyment for a time.} means, on earth you will have dwellings and known, designated, appointed terms that have been recorded by the Pen, counted by Predestination and written in the First Record. 4He (Allah) said : "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, and from it you shall be brought out (resurrected)." } This Ayah is similar to Allah's other statement, ft &p4 pa iThereof (the earth) We created you, and into it We shall return you, and from it We shall bring you out once again.} 20 :55]. Allah states that He has made the earth a dwelling place for the Children of Adam, for the remainder of this earthly life. On it, they will live, die and be buried in their graves; and from it, they will be resurrected for the Day of Resurrection. On that Day, Allah will gather the first and last of creatures and reward or punish each according to his or her deeds. oi «^4'j j*«- viUj JXt'j liijj 'Sjy Qf jj fx xsr~t\$ 4^ 'ofA'A 426. O Children of Adam! We have bestowed Libas (raiment) upon you to cover yourselves with, and as Rish (adornment) and the Libas (raiment) of Taqwa, that is better. Such are among tlte Ayat of Allah, that they may remember.} Bestowing Raiment and Adornment on Mankind Allah reminds His servants that He has given them Libas and Rish. Libas refers to the clothes that are used to cover the private parts, while Rish refers to the outer adornments used

41 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (26 - 27) (Part-8) for purposes of beautification. Therefore, the first type is essential while the second type is complimentary. Ibn Jarir said that Rish includes furniture and outer clothes.111 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on the Ayah, iand the Libds (raiment) of Taqwa...} "When one fears Allah, Allah covers his errors. Hence the 'Libas of Taqwa.' (that the Ayah mentions). ",21 I- 'jll p^arVi.ii V |»S'« Zjr~i¥ &S 'i itk P* ft 427. O Children of Adam! Let not Shaytan deceive you, as he got your parents out of Paradise, stripping them of their raiment, to show them their private parts. Verily, he and his tribe see you from where you cannot see them. Verily, We made the Shaydtin friends of those who believe not.}

Warning against the Lures of Shaytan

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1912–2071]

Allah warns the Children of Adam against Iblis and his followers, by explaining about his ancient enmity for the father of mankind, Adam peace be upon him. Iblis plotted to have Adam expelled from Paradise, which is the dwelling of comfort, to the dwelling of hardship and fatigue (this life) and caused him to have his private part uncovered, after it had been hidden from him. This, indeed, is indicative of deep hatred (from Shaytan towards Adam and mankind). Allah said in a similar Ayah, 05-s^iiU J-L jit | iij (jjj Oi 'Cijj1 ^ iWill you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than

Me, while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers.} [18:50]. 111 At-Tabari 12:364. 121 At-Tabari 12:368.

1* \Vj \$ -1 ji Tg)^£; * c \$ & SJS^f v>- ^/J Mi/ JS'IjJ CT CfjJt ij ijdj <q^syys^ it^» :ti;1 4L0>(Ij3&^ SSUif <28. And when they commit a Fahishah, they say: "We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us." Say: "Nay, Allah never commands Fahishah. Do you say about Allah what you know not?") 429. Say: "My Lord has commanded justice and that you should face Him only, in every Masjid and invoke Him only, making your religion sincere to Him. As He brought you (into being) in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again") 430. A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error; (because) surely, they took the Shaydtin as supporters instead of Allah, and think that they are guided.) Disbelievers commit Sins and claim that Allah commanded Them to do so! Mujahid said, "The idolaters used to go around the House {Ka'bah} in Tawaf while naked, saying, 'We perform fawdfas our mothers gave birth to us.' The woman would cover her sexual organ with something saying, Today, some or all of it will appear, but whatever appears from it, I do not allow it (it is not for aduleity or for men to enjoy looking at!).'" Allah sent down the Ayah, it i'A% tc er; \ti //V 4 And when they commit a Fahishah (sin), they say: 'We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us.'>[7:28]m I say, the Arabs, with the exception of the Quraysh, used to perform Tawaf naked. They claimed they would not make Tawaf while wearing the clothes that they disobeyed Allah in. As for the Quraysh, known as Al-Hums, * they used to 111 Literally: strictly religious. Called such, as they used to say. We are the people of Allah, we shall not go out of the sanctuary.' At-Tabari 12:377.

43 Siirah 7. Al-A'rdf (28 - 30) (Part-8) perform Tawaf in their regular clothes. Whoever among the Arabs borrowed a garment from one of Al-Hums, he would wear it while in Tawaf. And whoever wore a new garment, would discard it and none would wear it after him on completion of Tawaf. Those who did not have a new garment, or were not given one by Al-Hums, then they would perform Tawaf while naked. Even women would go around in Tawaf while naked, and one of them would cover her sexual organ with something and proclaim, "Today, a part or all of it will appear, but whatever appears from it I do not allow it." Women used to perform Tawaf while naked usually at night. This was a practice that the idolaters invented on their own, following only their forefathers in this regard. They falsely claimed that what their forefathers did was in fact following the order and legislation of Allah. Allah then refuted them, Allah said, iijtj tJwj ijli i And when they commit a Fdhishah, they say : "We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us."} Allah does not order Fahsha', but orders Justice and Sincerity Allah replied to this false claim, \$Say}, O Muhammad, to those who claimed this, >3 at <, [} i "Nay, Allah never commands Fahsha'..."} meaning, the practice you indulge in is a despicable sin, and Allah does not command such a thing. i "Do you say about Allah what you know not?"} that is, do you attribute to Allah statements that you are not certain are true? Allah said next, i Say : "My Lord has commanded justice, (fairness and honesty)"},

4& k/ •> .je-jij 4 "And that you should face Him only, in every Masjid, and invoke Him only making your religion sincere to Him ..."> This Ayah means, Allah commands you to be straightforward in worshipping Him, by following the Messengers who were supported with miracles and obeying what they conveyed from Allah and the Law that they brought. He also commands sincerity in worshipping

Him, for He, Exalted He is, does not accept a good deed until it satisfies these two conditions: being correct and in conformity with His Law, and being free of Shirk.

The Meaning of being brought into Being in the Beginning and brought back again Allah's saying 4*£ZpZ cr» 4^s He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again> [7:29]. Until; ierror.^ There is some difference over the meaning of: fi'Z l2> 4-As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again .4 Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that it means, "He will bring you back to life after you die." **l Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented, "As He made you begin in this life. He will bring you back to life on the Day of Resurrection. |21 Qatadah commented on: 4<>/iyupZ L<f£ 4As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again .4 At-Tabari 12:385. At-Tabari 12:385.

"He started their creation after they were nothing, and they perished later on, and He shall bring them back again." 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "As He created you in the beginning, He will bring you back in the end."121 This last explanation was preferred by Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir and he supported it with what he reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "The Messenger of Allah sg stood up and gave us a speech, saying, iliA 4il JI >01 \£\ U 45'1' U) llde 'lij tfS. 3 di: (Z) ri «0 people! You will be gathered to Allah while barefooted, naked and uncircumcised, 4As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do 1:104] This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahihs . [41 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, pi <Z) 4As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again. A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error;) "Allah, the Exalted, began the creation of the Sons of Adam, some believers and some disbelievers, just as He said. 4He it is Who created you, then some of you are disbelievers and some ofyou are believers) [64:2]. He will then return them on the Day of Resurrection as He started them, some believers and some disbelievers.151 I say, what supports this meaning, is the Hadith from Ibn Mas*ud that Al-Bukhari recorded, (that the Prophet jg said:) m At-Tabari 12:385. At-Jabari 12:385. 131 At-Tabari 12:386. 141 Fath Al-Bari 6 :445 and 8 :135 and Muslim 4 :2194 |S| At-Tabari 12:382.

46 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr «By He, other than Whom there is no god, one of you might perform the deeds of the people ofParadise until only the length of an arm or a forearm would separate him from it. However, that which was written in the Book takes precedence, and he commits the work of the people of the Fire and thus enters it. And one of you might perform the deeds of the people of the Fire until only the length of an arm or a forearm separates between him and the Fire. However, that which was written in the Book takes precedence, and he performs the work of the people ofParadise and thus enters Paradise. We should combine this meaning - if it is held to be the correct meaning for the Ayah - with Allah's statement: 4So set you your face towards the religion, Hanifan. Allah's Fitrah loith which He has created mankind \$> [30:30], and what is recorded in the Two Sahlhs from Abu Hurayrah who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: jll\j2aiiJ o\jj(i jJjJ (JS8 *Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, it is only his parents who turn him into a Jew, a Christian or a Zoroastrian. »'31 Muslim recorded that Tyad bin Himar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. i* && JI :JJU5 & l J 'rt FathAl-B&ri 11:486. ' The meaning of this Ayah is, "Dedicate yourself to the natural religion ofAllah which Hemade for humanity." Fath Al-B&ri 3 :290 and Muslim 4 :2047

47 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (28 - 30) (Part-8) Allah said, 7 created My servants Hunafa' (monotheists), but the devils came to them and deviated them from their religion .»(11 The collective meaning here is, Allah created His creatures so that some of them later turn believers and some turn disbelievers. Allah has originally created all of His servants able to recognize Him, to single Him out in worship, and know that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He also took their covenant to fulfill the implications of this knowledge, which He placed in their consciousness and souls. He has decided that some of them will be miserable and some will be happy, io'S1 Jft 4He it is Who created you, then some of you are disbelievers and some of you are believers} [64:2]. Also, a Hadith states, jA*j ^ull JS iAll people go out in the morning and sell themselves, and some of them free themselves while some others destroy themselves. »l2) Allah's decree will certainly come to pass in His creation. Verily, He it is 3 4ft iWho has measured (everything); and then guided [87:3], and, 4He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright (20:50). And in the Two Sahihs: ^4 ssuDi jil ^ b\sX 156» •yUill Jit ^4 Vj&' Jit If* 'J* lib *jSli—11 JUJ 1,1 Muslim 4:2197. 121 Muslim 1 :203

“As for those among you who are among the people of happiness, they will be facilitated to perform the deeds of the people of happiness. As for those who are among the miserable, they will be facilitated to commit the deeds of the miserable. 111 This is why Allah said here, j. ** > « <'<' [vplc Viy*J if-U 4A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error ;)> Allah then explained why, {Qji ijji% ibecause) surely, they took the Shaydtin as supporters instead of Allah). Ibn Jarir said, “This is one of the clearest arguments proving the mistake of those who claim that Allah does not punish anyone for disobedient acts he commits of deviations he believes in until after knowledge of what is correct reaches him, then he were to obstinately avoid it anyway. If this were true, then there would be no difference between the deviations of the misguided group - their belief that they are guided - and the group that is in fact guided. Yet Allah has differentiated between the two in this noble Ayah, doing so in both name and judgement.”121 *** At-Tabari 12:388. See the explanation of Surat At-Tawbah 9:115, and At-Tabari's comments on it. Path Al-Bari 3 :267 and Muslim 4 :2039 mm~ V. s'S* "£,** < ".Xis ' ><»- A -i »3SJ

49 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (31) (Part-8) i V ft % iES5 gfc-S^ £ i* 3SLj Wt fsc 431. O Children of Adam! Take your adornment to every Masjid, and eat and drink, but waste not by extravagance, certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful.) Allah commands taking Adornment when going to the Masjid This honorable Ayah refutes the idolators' practice of performing Tawaf around the Sacred House while naked. Muslim, An-Nasal and Ibn Jarir, (the following wording is that of Ibn Jarir) recorded that Shu*bah said that Salamah bin Kuhayl said that Muslim Al-Batin said that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said, “The idolators used to go around the House while naked, both men and women, men in the day and women by night. The woman would say, “Today, a part or all of it will be unveiled, but whatever is exposed of it, I do not allow.”111 Allah said in reply, its-*\$ 'M h<k> iTake your adornment to every Masjid,) Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on: iTake your adornment to every Masjid) “There were people who used to perform Tawaf around the House while naked, and Allah ordered them to take adornment, meaning, wear clean, proper clothes that cover the private parts, people were commanded to wear their best clothes when performing every prayer.”121 Mujahid, 'Ata\ Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ad- Dahhak and Malik narrated a similar saying from Az-Zuhri , and from

several of the Salaf. They said that this Ayah was Muslim 4:2320, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra, 6:345 and At-Tabari 121 At-Tabari 12:391 131 At-Tabari 12:392-394.

51 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(31) (Part-8) that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, jls <}aj {jA »l£j ^il £^1 li (Ut^ ^ «77ie Son of Adam will not fill a pot worse for himself than his stomach. It is enough for the Son of Adam to eat a few bites that strengthens his spine. If he likes to have more, then let him fill a third with food, a third with drink and leave a third for his breathingV An-Nasal and At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith,^ At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan" or "Hasan Sahih" according to another manuscript. 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, 4And eat and drink but waste not by extravagance, certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful . "With food and drink."13' Ibn Jarir commented on Allah's statement, 4-4 ^Certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful. "Allah the Exalted says that He does not like those who trespass the limits on an allowed matter or a prohibited matter, those who go to the extreme over what He has allowed, allow what He has prohibited, or prohibit what He has allowed. But, He likes that what He has allowed be considered as such (without extravagance) and what He has prohibited be considered as such. This is the justice that He has commanded."4' 4 u? J* OJ J gfo •Jjil *ul iij (j>- £ .2i .-Jtff t "4> Ahmad 4:132. |2' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi7:51 and An-Nasal 4 : 178 31 At-Tabari 12:394. 4| At-Tabari 12:395.

432. Say: "Who has forbidden the adornment with clothes given by Allah, which He has produced for His servants, and At-Tayyibdt (good things) of sustenance?" Say: "They are, in the life of this world, for those who believe, (and) exclusively for them (believers) on the Day of Resurrection ." Thus We explain the Aydt in detail for people who have knowledge.} Allah refutes those who prohibit any type of food, drink or clothes according to their own understanding, without relying on what Allah has legislated. 4Say\$ O Muhammad, to the idolators who prohibit some things out of false opinion and fabrication, 4'hQ zP iSj yj- zb iWho has forbidden the adornment with clothes given by Allah, which He has produced for His servants} meaning, these things were created for those who believe in Allah and worship Him in this life, even though the disbelievers share in these bounties in this life. In the Hereafter, the believers will have all this to themselves and none of the disbelievers will have a share in it, for Paradise is prohibited for the disbelievers. U Zfo fs 'jy> (Or 433. Say: "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are the Fawdliish (immoral deeds) whether committed openly or secretly, and Ithrn, and transgression without right, and joining partners with Allah for which He has given no authority, and saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge Fahishah, Sin, Transgression, Shirk and Lying about Allah are prohibited Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 'jj 1 ^0 L* 4)1 ^ja Ap-i V®

Surah 7, Al-A'rdf(32 - 33) (Part-8 "None is more jealous than Allah, and this is why He prohibited Fawdhish, committed openly or in secret. And none likes praise more than AZ/a/ii.' 11 This was also recorded in the Two Sahfhs.*2 * In the explanation of Surat Al-An'am, we explained the Fahishah that is committed openly and in secret. Allah said next, A#6» iand Ithm, and transgression without right, (7:331- As-Suddi commented, "Al-Ithm means, 'disobedience'. As for unrighteous oppression, it occurs when you transgress against people without justification. "3 * Mujahid said, "Ithm includes all types of disobedience. Allah said that the oppressor commits oppression against himself."14 * Therefore, the meaning of, Ithm is the sin that one commits against himself, while 'oppression' pertains to

transgression against other people, and Allah prohibited both. Allah's statement, iand joining partners with Allah for which He has given no authority, prohibits calling partners with Allah in worship. iand saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge.> such as lies and inventions, like claiming that Allah has a son, and other evil creeds that you - O idolators - have no knowledge of. This is similar to His saying: 4So shun the abomination (worshipping) of the idols£ [22:30]. m Ahmad 1:381. * Fath Al-Bari 9 :230 and Muslim 4:2114. * At-Tabari 12:403. > At-Tabari 12:403.

434. And every Ummah has its appointed term; when their term comes, neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment).} 435. O Children of Adam! If there come to you Messengers from among you, reciting to you My Aydt, then whosoever has Taqwd and becomes righteous, on them shall be no fear nor shall they grieve.} 436. But those who reject Our Aydt and treat them with arrogance, they are the dwellers of the Fire, they will abide thereinforever.} Allah said, 4And every Ummah has}, meaning, each generation and nation, <&%.%#} 4its appointed term; when their term comes} which they were destined for, 4neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment)}. Allah then warned the Children of Adam that He sent to them Messengers who conveyed to them His Aydt Allah also conveyed good news, as well as warning, ip 4then whosoever has Taqwd and becomes righteous} by abandoning the prohibitions and performing acts ofobedience. 4X£ fiH 4on them shall be no fear nor shall they grieve. But those who reject Our Aydt and treat them with arrogance,} meaning, their hearts denied the Aydt and they were too

55Surah 7. Al-A'raf(34 - 37) (Part-8) arrogant to abide by them, q |U> .>uf itthey are the dwellers of the Fire, they will abide therein forever.} without end to their dwelling in it. # ^ ^ i c^r## igf^ 50 4i^vS^ | Jit £ 437. Who is more unjust than one who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt? For such their appointed portion will reach them from the Book (of Decrees) until Our messengers (the angel ofdeath and his assistants) come to them to take their souls, they (the angels) will say: "Where are those whom you used to invoke and worship besides Allah," they will reply, "They have vanished and deserted us." And they will bear witness against themselves, that they were disbelievers.} Idolators enjoy Their destined Share in This Life, but will lose Their Supporters upon Death Allah said, o&f& 50£} 4Who is more unjust than one who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt?} meaning, none is more unjust than whoever invents a lie about Allah or rejects the Ayat that He has revealed. Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi said that, 4^0S f&J jiS^} 4For such their appointed portion will reach them from the Book} refers to each person's deeds, allotted provisions and age. Similar was said by Ar-Rabl' bin Anas and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin AslamJ2 * Allah said in similar statements, At-Tabari 12:413. At-Tabari 12:413-414.

•>* ./ ,> <. i* . *// ^ > .•* y ,/Λr! -{/ - >;^ ^ bjJJ ^ ..W, V V>J~' J6 H_ _ . _ . c*ji' '*•' ojj&i iyli==> ll> jujuilt .- |l> is il iVerily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve .> (10:69-70) and, 4yJi iAnd whoever disbelieves, let not his disbelief grieve you . To Us is their return, and We shall inform them what they have done. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat is in the breasts (ofmen). We let them enjoyfor a little while. [31:23-24]. Allah said next, iuntil when Our messengers come to them to take their souls.} Allah states that when death comes to the idolaters and the angels come to capture their souls to take them to

Hellfire, the angels horrify them, saying, "Where are the so-called partners (of Allah) whom you used to call in the life of this world, invoking and worshipping them instead of Allah? Call them so that they save you from what you are suffering." However, the idolaters will reply, i"They have vanished and deserted us"} meaning, we have lost them and thus, we do not hope in their benefit or aid, iAnd they will bear witness against themselves^ they will admit and proclaim against themselves, ithat they were disbelievers.}

57Surah 7. Al-A'raf (38 - 39) (Part-8 ^Er? ot \y»- \J» v. (i-^uSu O^JbO^,^Cj)ljui*b JISjO 1^UjL^SjIAc- "/>, / # >» ijL^ji^i^ifj\$4^^jujig JLiJ»pV^blll ^ ^ i*, Jioif*A>J^-*5 ^4/J s>&3&&z3vj^jtiz pio^y \$38. (Allah) will say: "Enter you in the com- pany of nations who passed away before you, of men and Jinn, into the Fire." Every time a new nation enters, it curses its sister nation (that went before) until they are all together in the Fire. The last of them will say to the first of them : "Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire." He will say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you know not."} <39. The first of them will say to the last of them: "You were not better than us, so taste the tormentfor what you used to earn."} ij^ CiU Ji 4 Ijliol J5^ j 0^ O 1,11.1 ••U iit cJti Li jQi cJtt L-^- 1}v m % &h jj UiJa C'Lt p^lii y Siv p ju >t ts P & UA <" >/ •< Lj iyjji JL>> i> People ofthe Fire will dispute and curse Each Other Allah mentioned what He will say to those who associate others with Him, invent lies about Him, and reject His Ayat, 4A 4 tf&» 4Enter you in the company of nations}, who are your likes and similar to you in conduct,

59Surah 7. Al-A'raf (38 - 39) (Part-8) the first nations to enter. This is because the earlier nations were worse criminals than those who followed them, and this is why they entered the Fire first. For this reason, their followers will complain against them to Allah, because they were the ones who misguided them from the correct path, saying, ip\ C\Z £> 4"Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire."} multiply their share of the torment. Allah said in another instance, q% tflij Ob ai M j 420 crJuL* \j ijVjbUcJl UJjL. 0,1 40« the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh! Would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger." And they will say: "Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the (right) way. Our Lord! Give them a double torment."} [33:66-68]. Allah said in reply, p.0 4He will say: "For each one there is double (torment)..."}, We did what you asked, and recompensed each according to their deeds.' Allah said in another Ayah, o* "xfc ^Jjf} iThose who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them We will add torment}[!6:88]. Furthermore, Allah said, [SS d£2S} iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own} [29:13] and, iAnd also (some thing) of the burdens of those whom they

60 Tafstr Ibn Kathir misled without knowledge} (16:25]. 4The first of them will say to the last of them meaning, the followed will say to the followers, a} 4"You were not better than us..."} meaning, you were led astray as we were led astray, according to As-Suddi.111 4>jJZ c;u&} 4"So taste the tormentfor what you used to earn."} Allah again described the condition of the idolaters during the gathering (of Resurrection), when He said; & jr* km iszs# o' i) JZ-* J5 iIs&LJ Ct&t cA\ J15) "fp'Oryj/ i? Q J&K U^j \% O Z\j3\ foil il ^3 !>•“ “ VI ji c?jil <And //lose who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it come to you? Nay, but you were criminals." Those wlvw were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your

plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, when they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} [34:32-33] gfi <\$* OjUoj% .jJ*\ ZijS "fk gji v tfi lfi»s2_0l> lliSiL iyIs"" o),^ 0;j >l-n oi fX ZipCgfuix A%iEs*j iCii j Jill / .'y v c n/' <40. Verily, those who belie Our Aydt and treat them with m At-Tabari 12 :420.

62Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(40 - 41) (Part-8) arrogance, for than the gates of the heavens will not be opened, and they will not enter Paradise until the Jamal goes through the eye of the needle. Thus do We recompense the criminals.} 441. Theirs will be Mihad from the Fire, and over them Ghawdsh. Titus do We recompense the wrongdoers.} Doors of Heaven shall not open for Those Who deny Allah's Ayat, and They shall never enter Paradise Allah said, i&l&pp'i} ifor them the gates of the heavens will not be opened,} meaning, their good deeds and supplication will not ascend through it, according to Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Ibn 'Abbas, as Al-'Awfi and 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from him. 1 ' 1 Ath-Thawri narrated that, Layth said that 'Ata' narrated this from Ibn 'Abbas.¹² It was also said that the meaning here is that the doors of the heavens will not be opened for the disbelievers* souls, according to Ad-Dahhak who reported this from Ibn 'Abbas.¹³¹ As-Suddi and severed others mentioned this meaning. What further supports this meaning, is the report from Ibn Jarir that Al-Bara' said that the Messenger of Allah mentioned capturing the soul of the 'Fajtf (wicked sinner or disbeliever), and that his or her soul will be ascended to heaven. The Prophet said, ?LiJi .li U ijJU V) <&&ii ji & JU 'fa 4 1* b «1j yi i) i*i; o .ilui «So they (angels) ascend it and it will not pass by a gathering of the angels, but they will ask, who's wicked soul is this?' They will reply, 'The soul of so-and-so,' calling him by the 111 At-Tabari 12:422-423. 121 At-Tabari 12:422. At-Tabari 12:422. At-Tabari 12:422.

63Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (42 - 43) (Part-8) Dahhak bin Muzahim and As-Suddi. * Allah said next, <Sy? <A%j} <(77ims do We recompense the wrongdoers.} £ hs^ ^ vi n* J£2 * ip:^5> c£jil <i Jui IjJUj jvV> jlfj* 0; 4/? 0; 4 £ Hjij |gj l«j £l: J \;i& Jii G iii *2; 3 & &£ 3 Vjj S' e uSl^ 4i|*5jH5& e* £V 442. But those who believed, and worked righteousness - We burden not any person beyond his scope - such are the dwellers of Paradise. They will abide therein .} 443. And We shall remove from their breasts any Ghill ; rivers flowing under them, and they will say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has guided us to this, and never could we have found guidance, were it not that Allah had guided us! Indeed, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth." And it will be cried out to them : "This is the Paradise which you have inherited for what you used to do."} Destination of Righteous Believers After Allah mentioned the condition of the miserable ones, He then mentioned the condition of the happy ones, saying, \pr. <Z\$j} 4But those who believed, and worked righteousness} Their hearts have believed and they performed good deeds with their limbs and senses, as compared to those who disbelieved in the Ayat of Allah and were arrogant with them. Allah also said that embracing faith and implementing it are easy, when He said. •> *1 Vi OS pftpii 4 C & 4But those who believed, and worked righteousness - We 111 At-Jabari 12:436.

burden not any person beyond his scope - such are the dwellers of Paradise. They will abide therein. And We shall remove from their breasts any Ghill; } meaning, envy and hatred. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^ ji? I j&j lil c/>- tljjdl ^ QUJjL jls Jal

eJ^i\^ oJLj ^--a. "After the believers are saved from entering the Fire, they zwill be kept in wait by a bridge between Paradise and Hellfire. Then, transgression that occurred between than in the life of this world will be judged. Until, when they are purified and cleansed, they will be given permission to enter Paradise. By He in Whose Hand is my soul! One of them will be able to find his dwelling in Paradise more so than he did in the life of this world .»ll) As-Suddi said about Allah's statement, <&£ iik 4 ^ iAnd We shall remove from their breasts any Ghill; rivers flowing under than,} "When the people of Paradise are taken to it, they will find a tree close to its door, and two springs from under the trunk of that tree. They will drink from one of them, and all hatred will be removed from their hearts, for it is the cleansing drink. They will take a bath in the other, and the brightness of delight will radiate from their faces. Ever after, they will never have messy hair or become dirty." 121 An-Nasaland Ibn Marduwyah (this being his wording) recorded thatAbu Hurayrah said that the Messenger ofAllah said, aJ A^lia 4)1 jf J tjlljl ^jA oJLmjLA \Ejj I JjfcI 1.IX 4)1 (jf jJ a!>xJ l ^jA oJalAA iSji J » 3 111 Fath Al-Bari 5:115. 121 At-Jabari 12:439.

x «Each of the people of Paradise will see his seat in the Fire and he will say, 'Had not Allah guided me! And this will cause him to be grateful. Each of the people of the Fire zuill see his seat in Paradise, and he will say, 'Might that Allah had guided me!' So it will be a cause of an- guish for Wra.i111 This is why when the believers are awarded seats in Paradise that belonged to the people of the Fire, they will be told, "This is the Paradise that you inherited because of what you used to do." This means, because of your good deeds, you earned Allah's mercy and thus entered Paradise and took your designated dwellings in it, comparable to your deeds. This is the proper meaning here, for it is recorded in the Two Sahths that the Prophet jg said, ill- l) jl "And knoiv that the good deeds of one of you will not admit him into Paradise .» UU ifji ' \Xfffx* jl 1 1 / > *y */./ ./ " •/> r*/ sEJ i -C-&j*~\$**j_ They said, "Not even you, O Allah's Messenger?" He said, j» 4i>! Nj lii «Not even I, unless Allah grants it to me out ofHis mercy and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :447

favor, n11 ' l*»- J&j U ^ju>j U*> Uy L liju-j ju ^ jGJI t— r"" %"*." -f , ^ * r *•>' ' -If . ifif ^ i; < *>'~ f*t ;> l' \s yj*-j 5s sWt' j6 *JJ-i^ad u^' aUI o' p-p^ . >a> 'jJli 4 sjfi\ |A) <44. And Me dwellers of Paradise will call out to the dwellers of the Fire (saying) : "We have indeedfound true what our Lord had promised us; have you also found true what your Lord promised (warned)?" They shall say: "Yes." Then a crier will proclaim between them: "The curse of Allah is on the wrongdoers."> <45. Those who hindered (men) from the path of Allah, and would seek to make it crooked, and they were disbelievers in the Hereafter. People of Hellfire will feelAnguishuponAnguish Allah mentioned how the people of the Fire will be addressed, chastised and admonished when they take then- places in the Fire, <"We (dwellers of Paradise) have indeed found true what our Lord had promised us; luwe you (dwellers of Hell) also found true what your Lord promised (warned)?" They shall say: "Yes."> In Surat As-Saffat, Allah mentioned the one who had disbelieving companion. Crt ilSJ^ ili S/Jj Q;y_}jA <So lie looked down and saw him in the midst of the Fire. He said: "By Allah! You have nearly ruined me. Had it not been for the grace of my Lord, I would certainly have been among those brought forth (to Hell)." (The dwellers of Paradise will say!) "Are we then not to die (any more)? Except our first 111 FathAl-Bdri 11 :300 and Muslim 4:2170.

67 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (44 - 45) (Part-8) death, and we shall not be punished?"} [37:55-59]. Allah will punish the disbeliever for the claims he used to utter in this life. The angels will also admonish the disbelievers, saying, V Ijc* LJj IT Cē2 Gi IT' IAG y iThis is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste you therein its heat and whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you used to do} [52:14-16]. The Messenger of Allah jg admonished the inhabitants of the well at Badr: • «* ' -* • #<•* \ »«*<» ' ' * •! * I + • I " I"! I\y, #. « * * < * * + « j * ' < . • > , { < «0 Afw Jahl bin Hishaml O 'Utba bin Rabfah! O Shaybah bin Rabi'ah (and he called their leaders by name)! Have you found what your Lord promised to be true (the Fire)? I certainly found what my Lord has promised me to be true (victory). Umar said, "O Allah's Messenger! Do you address a people who have become rotten carrion?" He jg said. ifoA^: 'i& ' -J I WV W • By He in Whose Hand is my soul! You do not hear what I am saying better than they do, but they cannot reply. Allah's statement, I.,-~ '?frV Tf-rV. iThen a crier will proclaim between them} will herald and announce, Je 4al ild 4The curse of Allah is on the wrongdoers} meaning, the curse will I1 * Muslim 3:2203. Those were the disbelievers of the Quraysh who were killed at the battle of Badr, Their corpses were thrown into the well.

69 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (46 - 47) (Part-8 that Allah described, iSo a wall will be put up between them, with a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it will be torment. [57:13] It is also about Al-A'raf that Allah said, iXj iand on Al-A'raf will be men}." 111 Ibn Jarir recorded that As-Suddi said about Allah's statement, ibk<& } iAnd between them will be a screen "It is the wall, it is Al- A 'raf. " *21 Mujahid said, uAl-A'raf is a barrier between Paradise and the Fire, a wall that has a gate." *31 Ibn Jarir said, "Al-A'raf is plural for 'Urf where every elevated piece of land is known as 'Urf to the Arabs." As-Suddi said, "Al-A'raf is so named because its residents recognize (Ya'rifun) the people. Al-A'raf's residents are those whose good and bad deeds are equal, as Hudhayfah, Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and several of the Salaf and later generations said." Ibn Jarir recorded that Hudhayfah was asked about the people of Al-A'raf and he said, "A people whose good and bad deeds are equal. Their evil deeds prevented them from qualifying to enter Paradise, and their good deeds qualified them to avoid the Fire. Therefore, they are stopped there on the wall until Allah judges them." *41 Ma'mar said that Al-Hasan recited this Ayah, iand at that time they will not yet have entered it (Paradise), but they will hope to enter (it).} Then he said, "By Allah! Allah did not put this hope in their hearts, except for an honor that He intends to bestow on At-Tabari 12:249. At-Tabari 12:449. 131 At-Tabari 12 :451 ,4! At-Tabari 12:453.

72 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (50 - 51) (Part-8) bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas, it 4Are they those, of whom you swore that Allah would never show them mercy? refers to the people of Al-A'raf who will be told when Allah decrees: 4(Behold! It has been said to them): "Enter Paradise, no fear shall be on you, nor shall you grieve.' V r^u %s c. % \$\$ os eL& 'M 5 M&& \j\Es» Uj l-ii* >pj> IjLi ^ | v .Vi ^5u 450. And the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise : "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provided you with." They will say: "Both (water and provision) Allah has forbidden for the disbelievers 451 . "Who took their religion as amusement and play, and the life of the world deceived them." So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this Day, and as they used to reject Our Aydt-4 The Favors of paradise are Prohibited for the People of the Fire Allah emphasizes the disgrace of the people of the Fire. They will ask the people of Paradise for some of their

drink and food, but they will not be given any of that. As-Suddi said, 4& « GL-& *4 3 jSP 4And the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise: "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provided you with "That is food".121 Ath-Thawri said that TJthman Ath-Thaqafi At-Tabari 12:469. At-Tabari 12:473.

said that Said bin Jubayr commented on this Ayah, "One of them will call his father or brother, 'I have been burned, so pour some water on me.' The believers will be asked to reply, and they will reply, jpo#-sSf 4"Both Allah has forbidden to the disbelievers ." } " * 1 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that, 4"Both Allah has forbidden to the disbelievers "Refers to the food and drink of Paradise." *21 Allah describes the disbelievers by what they used to do in this life, taking the religion as amusement and play, and being deceived by this life and its adornment, rather than working for the Hereafter as Allah commanded, 4'-^* -.-t'iJi Ui==» 4So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this Day meaning, Allah will treat them as if He has forgotten them. Certainly, nothing escapes Allah's perfect watch and He never forgets anything. Allah said in another Ayah, 4In a Record. My Lord neither errs nor forgets^ [20:52] Allah said - that He will forget them on that Day - as just recompense for them, because, i'fcgiSip 4They have forgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them} [9:67] i Jills' iLike this: Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded than, and so this Day, you will be neglected [20:126] and, *U! <T ^ At-Tabari 12:474. At-Tabari 12:474.

73Surah 7. Al-A'raf (51 - 52) (Part-8) (\$gDi& '«v c4 ' *'i<£' <;«' AT'i ! > '. I". r-'r-J J-^ jLoLolSJ'jjc,_)4> uJ 'jvJ ..AS 0/ \ f •; >J)V^>=Uqrr* Hi IJy~*- 5[lULjlji-oy.jtj ^:Vf ljl^*cii (i ly-li ' <AjL>-^»-li»LJ\ C^jS-J^ZJLm")JIS iAtid it will be said This Day We will forget you as you Jbrgot the meeting of this Day of yours." } (45:34) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on, i^>=» y\$ \>} 7-t<k '•&, 4So this Day We shall forget them as they Jbr- got their meeting of this Day} "Allah will forget the good about them, but not their evil." And 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "We shall forsake them as they have forsaken the meeting of this Day of theirs." Mujahid said, "We shall leave them in the Fire." As-Suddi said, "We shall leave them from any mercy, just as they left any action on behalf of the meeting on this Day of theirs." It is recorded in the Sahih that Allah will say to the servant on the Day of Resurrection: *£# 'Jf il Jflij Jili iu jff ?iu/f Jjf o.&r'd jjt j : _^U5 43)1 JjZj iV : lilii c.£bt «.,£J IIS «"Have I not gotten you married? Have I not honored you? Have I not made horses and camels subservient for you and allowed you to become a leader and a master?" He will say, "Yes." Allah will say, "Did you think that you will meet

Tahurum raimir Me?" He will say, "No." Allah the Exalted will say, "Then this Day, I will forget you as you have forgotten Me." J* CpajL-jf /A <^u ifi* ^4& <±£ U J-f» ,>jl ill, JiJ oiu. jj jj os jjL 4^5 Jus 15 ^^ 2to S' *jft £ i u \&Z <52. Certainly, We have brought to them a Book (the Qur'an) which We have explained in detail with knowledge, a guidance and a mercy to a people who believe i53. Await they just for the final fulfillment of the event? On the Day the event is finally fulfilled, those who neglected it before will say : "Verily, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back (to the first life of the world) so that we might do (good) deeds other than those (evil) deeds which we used to do?" Verily, they have lost themselves and that which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} The Idolaters have no Excuse Allah states that He has left no excuse for the idolaters, for He has sent to

them the Book that the Messenger came with, and which is explained in detail, i(This is) a Book, the Ayat whereof are perfected (in every sphere of knowledge), and then explained in detail > [11:1] Allah said next, iWe have explained in detail with knowledge> meaning, *We have perfect knowledge of what We explained in it'. Allah said in another Ayah, Muslim 4 :2279

75 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (52 - 53) (Part-8) 4He has sent it datum with His Knowledge,} [4:166] The meaning here is that after Allah mentioned the loss the idolators end up with in the Hereafter, He stated that He has indeed sent Prophets and revealed Books in this life, thus leaving no excuse for them. Allah also said; 4And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).> [17:15] This is why Allah said here, 4Await they just far the final fulfillment of the event?} in reference to what they were promised of torment, punishment, the Fire; or Paradise, according to Mujahid and several others. 11 ' 4On the Day the event is finally fulfilled,} on the Day of Resurrection, according to Ibn 'Abbas, 4those who neglected it before will say} those who ignored it in this life and neglected abiding by its implications will say, 4TS[A& :t& o-,UA 4"Verily, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf?"} so that we are saved from what we ended up in. 4"Or could we be sent back"}, to the first life, 4"So that we might do (good) deeds other than those (evil) deeds which we used to do?"}. Af-Tabari 12:479. 121 A-Mabari 12:479.

This part of the Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, & i g;^ tflfiM £% \ s5 %} yfc iz# Q !4£3 !AJ jt& *^ IX IS ^ n; if you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to them what they had been concealing before. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars [6:27-28] Allah said here, yu==» U jSj ii' •"4 rjfs. iVerily, they have lost themselves and tint which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} meaning, they destroyed themselves by entering the Fire for eternity, if £1 ££j} 4And that which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} What they used to worship instead of Allah abandoned them and will not intercede on their behalf, aid them or save them from their fate. !sj-Z f ; 4 i/yV?) c/^L1T\ jiu ^ji fit ^>[]} jii' j v* tsfh fjiz ji^if jjf 4 && i'C- 454. Indeed, your Lord is Allah, VJho created the heavens and the earth in Six Days, and then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne. He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} The Universe was created in Six Days Allah states that He created the universe, the heavens and

77 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (54) (Part-8) earth and all that is in, on and between them in six days, as He has stated in several Ayat in the Qur'an. These six days are: Sunday, Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday and Friday. On Friday, the entire creation was assembled and on that day, Adam was created. There is a difference of opinion whether these days were the same as our standard days as suddenly comes to the mind, or each day constitutes one thousand years, as reported from Mujahid , 1 ' 1 Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal, and from Ibn 'Abbas according to Ad-Dahhak's narration from him. As for Saturday, no creation took place in it since it is the seventh day of (of the week). The word 'As- Sabt' means stoppage, or break. Imam Ahmad recorded Abu Hurayrah saying: 'Allah's Messenger told me: >y jjajJt } i ^y- •«J^I tAllah created the dust on Saturday, and He created the mountains on Sunday, and

He created the trees on Monday, and He created the unpleasant things on Tuesday and He created the light on Wednesday and He spread the creatures through out it on Thursday and He created Adam after 'Asr on Friday. He was the last created during the last hour of Friday, between 'Asr and the night . Meaning of Istawa As for Allah's statement, and then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne the people had several conflicting opinions over its meaning. However, we follow the way that our righteous predecessors 111 At-Tabari 12:482. 12' Ahmad 2:327 and Muslim no. 2149

took in this regard, such as Malik, Al-Awzal, Ath-Thawri, Al- Layth bin Sa'd, Ash-Shafit, Ahmad, Ishaq bin Rahwayh and the rest of the scholars of Islam, in past and present times. Surely, we accept the apparent meaning of, Al-Istawa, without discussing its true essence, equating it (with the attributes of the creation), or altering or denying it (in any way or form). We also believe that the meaning that comes to those who equate AU4h with the creation is to be rejected, for nothing is similar to Allah, iThere is nothing like Him, and He is the All-Hearer, the All- Seer.) (42:11) Indeed, we assert and affirm what the Imams said, such as Nu'aym bin Hammad Al-Khuza'i, the teacher of Imam Al- Bukhari, who said, "Whoever likens Allah with His creation, will have committed Kufr. Whoever denies what Allah has described Himself with, will have committed Kufr. Certainly, there is no resemblance (of Allah with the creation) in what Allah and His Messenger^ have described Him with. Whoever attests to Allah's attributes that the plain Ayat and authentic Hadiths have mentioned, in the manner that suits Allah's majesty, all the while rejecting all shortcomings from Him, will have taken the path of guidance." The Day and the Night are among the Signs of Allah Allah said. ife S4' 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly,) meaning, the darkness goes away with the light, and the light goes away with the darkness. Each of them seeks the other rapidly, and does not come late, for when this vanishes, the other comes, and vice versa. Allah also said; iAnd a sign for them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the

79 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (54) (Part-8) day, and behold, they are in darkness . And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing. And the moon, We have measured for it mansions (to traverse) till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:37-40) Allah's statement, iNor does the night outstrip the day} (36:40) means, the night follows the day in succession and does not come later or earlier than it should be. This is why Allah said here, (>>jA j— 4seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command.} meaning, all are under His command, will and dominion. Allah alerted us afterwards, iSurely, His is the creation and commandment} the dominion and the decision. Allah said next, i\ isa iBlessed is Allah, the Lord of the all that exists!} which is similar to the Ayah, .till' 4 -&0} 4Blessed be He Who has placed in the heaven big stars} (25:61) Abu Ad-Darda' said a supplication, that was also attributed to the Prophet j* iiiUf iik £.>: Jjdp is iuii iii;& itiiit iu •*IS JI «iL *iS «0 Allah! Yours is all the kingdom, all the praise, and Yours is the ownership of all affairs. I ask You for all types of good and seek refuge with You from all types of evil.

and Khujyah}, with the humbleness in your hearts and certainty of His Oneness and Lordship not supplicating loudly to show off.111 Forbidding Aggression in Supplications It was reported that 'Ata' Al-Khurasani narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, who said about Allah's statement, 4<U£&U *At 4He likes not

the aggressors “In the Du’a’ and otherwise.” [2] Abu Mijlaz commented on, U vAt 4He likes not the aggressors>, “Such (aggression) as asking to reach the grade of the Prophets.”*31 Imam Ahmad narrated that Abu Ni’amah said that ‘Abdullah bin Mughaffal heard his son supplicating, “O Allah! I ask you for the white castle on the right side of Paradise, if I enter it.” So ‘Abdullah said, “O my son! Ask Allah for Paradise and seek refuge with Him from the Fire, for I heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, iThere will come some people who transgress in supplication and purification>”*41 Ibn MajahtS| and Abu Dawud |e| recorded this Hadlth with a good chain that there is no harm in, and Allah knows best. The Prohibition ofcausing Mischiefin the Land Allah said next, ufjVi" J 4And do not do mischief on the earth, after it has been set in order} [5:56]. At-Tabari 12:485. At-Tabari 12:486. At-Tabari 12:486. Ahmad 5 :55 151 Ibn Majah 2:2171. 161 Abu Dawud 1 :73.

^ &mm y mm ^ is0jjjJii js «J>jSo^ ^iljij^jljpSjj^SCi^as) 'ui^j^lilj^f^,iiwc/jKj*cljc1i 4^tj3c^JjJE&£e\$mi\$ ^jBl^jO^iitSuiSjii^ .*\$&. «* -.'5 / , - ^ ijlUAU'i—>jUid^J<j£^^.J ,*-"L^<^,j<>u Allah prohibits causing mischief on the earth, especially after it has been set in order. When the affairs are in order and then mischief occurs, it will cause maximum harm to the people; thus Allah forbids causing mischief and ordained worshipping Him, supplicating to Him, begging Him and being humble to Him. Allah said, ite; t£\&} iand invoke Him with fear and hope} fearing what He has of severe torment and hoping in what He has of tremendous reward. Allah then said, £* dyi& Sl> 4Surely , Allah's mercy is (ever) near unto the good-doers} meaning, His mercy is for the good-doers who obey His commands and avoid what He prohibited. Allah said in another Ayah, sjii ^r^—* ji> 'y i\$~*-ji} iAnd My mercy envelopes all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those who who have Taqwa.} [7:156]. Matar Al-Warraaq said, “Earn Allah’s promise by obeying Him, for He ordained that His mercy is near to the good-doers.” Ibn

83Surah 7. Al-A'raf (57 - 58) (Part-8 Abi Hatim collected this statement,m iiiii ^ {*} (XIIJ jj-1' Jj Uj& yiD <£* ^ £* 'S ££ .*& 6>k ft; £S.^ ^yJ u^*«j i/U'V^~o <57 . And it is He Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy (rain). Till when they have carried a heavy-laden cloud, We drive it to a land that is dead, then We cause water (rain) to descend thereon. Then We produce every kind offruit therewith. Similarly, We shall raise up the dead, so that you may remember or take heed.) i58 . The vegetation of a good land comes forth (easily) by the permission of its Lord; and that which is bad, brings forth nothing but (a little) with difficulty. Thus do We explain variously theAyatfor a people who give thanks.} AmongAllah’s Signs,HesendsdowntheRainandbrings forth the Produce After Allah stated that He created the heavens and earth and that He is the Owner and Possessor of the affairs Who makes things subservient (for mankind), He ordained that He be invoked in Du'd’, for He is able to do all things. Allah also stated that He is the Sustainer and He resurrects the dead on the Day of Resurrection. Here, Allah said that He sends the wind that spreads the clouds that are laden with rain. Allah said in another Ayah, AylrP of J-j{ o! jy} iAnd among His signs is this, that He sends the winds with glad tidings} (30:46). Allah's statement, Agoing before His mercy} means, before the rain. Allah also said; m Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1501

84 Tafsir Ibtî Kattrir iff *£\% frz2% 4And He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired, and spreads His mercy. And He is Al-Wali (the Guardian), Al-Hamid (the praiseworthy^ (42:28) and, dfi * 2)1 &££ }Look then at the results of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death. Verily,

that [is the one Who] shall indeed raise the dead, and He is able to do all things} [30:50]. Allah said next, *jjil Til -^} iTill when they have carried a heavy-laden cloud} when the wind carries clouds that are heavy with rain, and this is why these clouds are heavy, close to the earth, and their color is dark. Allah's statement. <i#A 4We drive it to a land that is dead} that is, a dry land that does not have any vegetation. This Ayah is similar to another Ayah, iAnd a signfor them is the dead land. We give it life} [36:33], This is why Allah said here, 43>*i' \ijf if ^ 'ii 4Then We produce every kind offruit therewith. Similarly, We shall raise up the dead.} meaning, just as We bring life to dead land, We shall raise up the dead on the Day of Resurrection, after they have disintegrated. Allah will send down rain from the sky and the rain will pour on the earth for forty days. The corpses will then be brought up in their graves, just as the seeds become grow in the ground (on receiving rain). Allah often mentions this similarity in the Qur'an when He gives the example of what will happen on the Day of Resurrection, and bringing life to dead land,*

iso that you may remember or take heed.} Allah's statement, <j»k fiQ £4. 4-^ '-ffiy} iThe vegetation of a good land comes forth (easily) by the permission of its Lord;} meaning, the good land produces its vegetation rapidly and proficiently. Allah said in another Ayah (about Maryam, mother of Isa, peace be upon him); i£H iHe made her groiu in a good manner.} [3:37] The Ayah continues, iand thatwhich is bad, bringsforth nothing but with difficulty.} Mujahid, and others such as As-Sibakh, etc. also said this . Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Mdsa said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, tijf } (JLjl ja a, li I U jii» wjISj ii.zjli ftLUl . * i • 1 . UJj **5^ 44 '4^4 '>*3j3 '3^-3 4^ £& iUJi ^<44 u^3 <ui j, *a if jii Jjyji c_L *u stLUj v 5uj v~ vS-4' cS-4 jii ^4 £fji 4 44 j4} jU*3 r4 «i)i "The parable of the guidance and knowledge with which Allah has sent me is that ofan abundant rain falling on a land, some of which was fertile soil that absorbed rain water and brought forth vegetation and grass in abundance. And another portion of it was hard and held the rain water; and Allah benefited the people with it, they utilized it for drinking, making their At-Tabari 12:497.*

animals drink from it, and for irrigation of the land for cultivation . And a portion of it was barren which could neither hold the water nor bring forth vegetation. The first is the example of the person who comprehends Allah's religion and gets benefit which Allah sent me with, by leamign and teaching others. The last example is that of a person who does not care for it and does not accept the guidance Allah sent me with.W 4 Sktf ^ ot JK <59 . Indeed, We sent Nuh to his people and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Certainly, Ifearfor you the torment ofa Great Day!"} 460. The leaders of his people said: "Verily, we see you in plain error."} 461. [Nuh] said: "O my people! There is no error in me, but I am a Messengerfrom the Lord ofall that exists!"} 462. I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord and give sincere advice to you. And I know from Allah what you know not."} The Story ofNuh and His People After Allah mentioned the story of Adam in the beginning of this Surah, He started mentioning the stories of the Prophets, the first then the latter of them. Allah mentioned the story of NOh, because he was the first Messenger Allah sent to the people of the earth after Adam. His name was Nah bin Lamak bin MatQshalakh bin KhanQkh. And Khanukh was, as they claim, the Prophet Idris. And Idris was the first person to write letters using pen, and he was the son of Barad bin Mahlil, bin Qanln bin Yanish bin Shith bin Adam, upon them all be peace. This lineage is mentioned by Muhammad bin Ishaq and other Im^ms who document lineage. 111 Fath Al-Bari 1:211.

87 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (59 - 62) (Part-8) 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas and several other scholars of Tafstr said that the first idol worship began when some righteous people died and their people built places of worship over their graves. They made images of them so that they could remember their righteousness and devotion, and thus, imitate them. When time passed, they made statues of them and later on worshipped these idols, naming them after the righteous people: Wadd, Suwa', YaghQth, Ya'dq and Nasr. After this practice became popular, Allah sent Ndh as a Messenger, all thanks are due to Him. Ntlh commanded his people to worship Allah alone without partners, saying, Sti 41 .4 & \j\$ 4%} i"0 my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Certainly, Ifearfor you the torment of a Great Day!"} the torment of the Day of Resurrection, if you meet Allah while associating others with Him. 4**?» Vat ji;» 4The leaders of his people said} meaning, the general public, chiefs, commanders and great ones of his people said, fU, 4 t\} 4"Verily, we see you in plain error"} because of your calling us to abandon the worship of these idols that we found our forefathers worshipping. This, indeed, is the attitude of evil people, for they consider the righteous people to be following misguidance. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd when they saw them, they said: "Verily, these have indeed gone astray!"} [83:32] and, 4^ -Sil 4And those who disbelieve say of those who believe: "Had it been a good thing, they (the weak and poor) xwould not have preceded us thereto!" And when they have not let themselves be

guided by it (this Qur'an), they say: "This is an ancient lie!"} [46:11] There are several other Aydt on this subject. yj OJ 3>ij Jpj cHI -aP*. i[Nuh] said: "O my people! There is no error in me, but I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists!"} meaning, there is nothing wrong with me, but I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists, Lord and King of all things, 4"I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord and give sincere advice to you. And I know from Allah what you know not."} This is the attribute of a Messenger, that he conveys using plain, yet eloquent words, offers sincere advice and is knowledgeable about Allah; indeed, no other people can compete with the Prophets in this regard. In his Sahlh, Muslim recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said to his Companions on the Day of 'Arafah, when their gathering was as large as it ever was, «0 people! You will be asked about me, so what will you s«y?» They said, "We testify that you have conveyed and delivered (the Message) and offered sincere advice." So he kept raising his finger to the sky and lowering it towards them, saying, •i'i rJfo «0 Allah! Bear witness, O Allah! Bear witness. **\$\$ #*3. js& ^5 a% an izk Ly 1 J&j AiLjfli 463. "Do you wonder that there has come to you a Reminder from your Lord through a man from among you, that he may m Muslim 2 :890

89 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (68 - 64) (Part-8) warn you, so that you may fear Allah and that you may receive (His) mercy?"} 464. But they belied him, so We saved him and those along with him in the Fulk, and We drowned those who belied Our Aydt. They were indeed a blind people.} Allah said that Nuh proclaimed to his people, 4"Do you wonder..."}, do not wonder because of this. Surely, it is not strange that Allah sends down revelation to a man among you as mercy, kindness and compassion for you, so that he warns you that you may avoid Allah's torment by associating none with Him, &hj} 4"and that you may receive (His) mercy."} Allah said, 4*>} 4But they belied him} but they insisted on rejecting and opposing him, and only a few of them believed in him, as Allah stated in another Ayah. Allah said next, 4So We saved him and those along with him in the Fulk} the ark, 4And We drowned those who belied Our Aydt.} Allah said in another Ayah, iBecause of their sins they were drowned, then they were admitted into the Fire. And they found none to help them instead of Allah.} [71:25] Allah said, Cy ijVfe.

£[] 4They were indeed a blind people.} meaning, blind from the Truth, unable to recognize it or find their way to it. Here, Allah said that He has taken revenge from His enemies and saved His

91Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(65 -69) (Part-8) said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Will you then not have Taqwa?"} 466. The leaders of those who disbelieved among his people said: "Verily, we see you in foolishness, and verily, we think you are one of the liars."} 467. (Hud) said : "O my people! There is no foolishness in me, but (I am) a Messengerfrom the Lord ofall that exists!} 468. "I convey unto you the Messages ofmy Lord, and I am a trustworthy adviser (or well-wisher) for you.} 469. "Do you wonder that there has come to you a Reminder (and an advice)from your Lord through a man from among you to warn you? And remember that He made you successors (generations after generations) after the people of Nuh and increased you amply in stature. So remember the graces (bestowed upon you) from Allah so that you may be successful."} The StoryofHud,PeacebeuponHim,andtheLineageof the People of'Ad Allah says, just as We sent Nilh to his people, similarly, to the 'Ad people. We sent Hud one of their own brethren. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the tribe of 'Ad were the descendants of 'Ad, son of Iram, son of 'Aws, son of Sam, son of Nuh. I say, these are indeed the ancient people of 'Ad whom Allah mentioned, the children of 'Ad, son of Iram who were living in the deserts with lofty pillars or statues. Allah said, 4 (A ^ j 4Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with 'Ad (people). Of Iram like (lofty) pillars . The like of which were not created in the land?} [89:6-8] because of their might and strength. Allah said in another instance, ij\$ \jj> frf »ji llj o* ijltt, *(c Oi} 4As for 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?" See they not

that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them. And they used to deny Our Aydt!} [41:15). The Land of'Ad The people of 'Ad lived in Yemen, in the area of Ahqaf, which means sand mounds. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Abu At-Tufayl 'Amir bin Wathilah said that he heard 'Ali (bin Abi Talib) saying to a man from Hadramawt (in Yemen), "Have you seen a red sand mound, where there are a lot of Arak and Lote trees in the area of so-and-so in Hadramawt? Have you seen it?" He said, "Yes, O Commander of the faithful! By Allah, you described it as ifyou have seen it before." 'Ali said, 1 have not seen it, but it was described to me." The man asked, "What about it, O Commander of the faithful?" 'Ali said, "There is the grave of Had, peace be upon him, in its vicinity." 1 11 Ibn Jarir recorded this statement, which gives the benefit of indicating that 'Ad used to live in Yemen, since Prophet Hud was buried there. Prophet Hud was among the noble men and chiefs of 'Ad, for Allah chose the Messengers from among the best, most honorable families and tribes. Had's people were mighty and strong, but their hearts were mighty and hard, for they were among the most denying of Truth among the nations. Prophet Hud called 'Ad to worship Allah alone without partners, and to obey and fear Him. Debate betweenHud and his People w « i£T 'IS tai iThe leaders of those who disbelieved among his people said ...> meaning, the general public, chiefs, masters and commanders of his people said, i&g3i P& 4 4"Verily, we see you in foolishness, and verily, we think you are one of the liars ' meaning, you are misguided because you call us to abandon worshipping the idols in order to worship Allah Alone. At-Tabari 12:507.

93Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(65 -69) (Part-8) Similarly, the chiefs of Quraysh wondered at the call to worship One God, saying, 4"Has he (Muhammad) made the gods (all) into One God?"} [38:5]. 4(Hud) said : "O

my people! There is no foolishness in me, but (I am) a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists!"} Hud said, I am not as you claim. Rather, I brought you the Truth from Allah, Who created everything, and He is the Lord and King of all things, 41%/oy) 45 4-&-V 4"I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord, and I am a trustworthy adviser for you."} These, indeed, are the qualities of the Prophets: conveying, sincerity and honesty, *5 \$># A% \$Zr i -£k 3» 4"Do you wonder that there has come to you a Reminder from your Lord through a man from among you to warn you?"} Prophet Hud said, do not wonder because Allah sent a Messenger to you from among yourselves to warn you about Allah's Days (His torment) and meeting with Him. Rather than wondering, you should thank Allah for this bounty. i^y SymU sGSt jto. i)M^%} 4"And remember that He made you successors (generations after generations) after the people of Nuh..."} meaning, remember Allah's favor on you in that He made you among the offspring of Nuh, because of whose supplication Allah destroyed the people of the earth after they defied and opposed him. 4"and increased you amply in stature."} making you taller than other people. Similarly, Allah said in the description of Talut

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95 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (70 - 72) (Part-8) Later on, the disbelievers of Quraysh said, ir* t,*jf. be* i>] f 1)1 ipL> I4ii ji ££li (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the people of Hud used to worship several idols, such as Suda', SamUd and Al-Haba'. This is why Hud, peace be upon him, said to them, " ' it. .V.i . -{V i"Rijs and wrath have already fallen on you from your Lord."} you deserve 'Rijs' from your Lord because of what you said. Ibn 'Abbas said that, 'Rijs', means scorn and anger. 11 ' ijss&z& i"Dispute you with me over names which you have named - you and your fathers?"} (7:71). Hud said, do you dispute with me over these idols that you and your fathers made gods, even though they do not bring harm or benefit; did Allah give you authority or proof allowing you to worship them? Hud further said, i"with no autlwritry from Allah? Then wait, I am with you among those who wait."} this is a threat and warning from the Messenger to his people. The End of Ad So Allah said; 1\$ Lj []>xk=s c/j t j\i ULLLSj fez j£sf&} iSo We saved him and those who were with him out of mercy |i| At-Tabari 12:522.

96 Tafsir Ibn Kathir from Us, and We severed the roots of those who belied Our Ayat; and they were not believers. Allah mentioned severed times in the Qur'an, the way the people of 'Ad were destroyed stating that He sent a barren wind that destroyed everything it passed by. Allah said in another Ayah, *وَجَاءَ مِنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ هَاجَاتٌ شَدِيدَةٌ لِيُصَاقَطَ فِي هَذِهِ الْأَرْضِ الَّتِي كَانَتْ تُعَذِّبُهَا عَنْ يَدِ اللَّهِ وَالْجَاثِمِينَ* [69:6-8] When 'Ad rebelled and transgressed, Allah destroyed them with a strong wind that carried them, one by one, up in the air and brought each one of them down on his head, thus smashing his head and severing it from its body. This is why Allah said, *وَجَاءَ مِنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ هَاجَاتٌ شَدِيدَةٌ لِيُصَاقَطَ فِي هَذِهِ الْأَرْضِ الَّتِي كَانَتْ تُعَذِّبُهَا عَنْ يَدِ اللَّهِ وَالْجَاثِمِينَ* [69:7] Muhammad bin Ishaq said that 'Ad used to live in Yemen between Oman and Hadramawt. They also spread throughout the land and defeated various peoples, because of the strength that Allah gave them. They used to worship idols instead of Allah, and Allah sent to them Prophet Hud, peace be upon him. He was from their most common lineage and was the best among them in status. Hud commanded them to worship Allah Alone and associate none with him. He also ordered them to stop committing injustice against the people. But they rejected him and ignored his call. They said, 'Who is stronger than us?' Some of them, however, followed Hud, although they were few and had to conceal their faith. When 'Ad defied the command of Allah, rejected His Prophet, committed mischief in the earth, became arrogant and built high palaces on every high place - without real benefit to them - Hud spoke to them, saying,

97 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (70 - 72) (Part-8) *وَمَا تَعْبُدُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَكُمْ أَنْتُمُ الْمُتَكَبِّرُونَ* "Do you build high palaces on every high place, while you do not live in them? And do you get for yourselves palaces (fine buildings) as if you will live therein forever. And when you seize (somebody), seize you (him) as tyrants? Have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me." (26:128-131) However, Ujuf ~ Sajli b i u" Jjii j("r, 4 They said: "O Hud! No evidence have you brought us, and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you. All that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil."} meaning, madness, ^ j* Wr s Cfi "csj-- S) u[jis^ 4* 4-> *jL a; ^ , \$4L> 4^ **** 4® dl 4 He said : "I call Allah to witness, and bear you witness that I am free from that which you associate with Him. So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path (the truth)." [11:53-56]." Story of the Emissary of 'Ad Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Harith Al-Bakri said: "I went to the Messenger of Allah to complain to him about Al-'Ala bin Al-Hadrami. When I passed by the area of Ar-Rabdhah, I found an old woman from Bani Tamim who was alone in that area. She said to me, "O servant of Allah! I need to reach the Messenger of Allah to ask him for some of my needs, will you?" At-Tabari 12:507.

98 Tafsir Ibn Kathir take me to him?" So I took her along with me to Al-Madina and found the Masjid full of people. I also found a black flag raised high, while Bilal was holding a sword before the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ). I asked, "What is the matter with the people?" They said, "The Prophet (ﷺ) intends to send 'Amr bin Al-'As (on a military expedition) somewhere." So I sat down. When the Prophet (ﷺ) went to his house, I asked for permission to see him, and he gave me permission. I entered and greeted him. He said, "Was there a dispute between you and Bani Tamim?" I said, "Yes. And we had been victorious over them. I passed by an old woman from Bani Tamim, who was alone, and she

asked me to bring her to you, and she is at the door". So he allowed her in and I said, "O Allah's Messenger! What if you make a barrier between us and (the tribe of) Bani Tamlm, such as Ad-Dahna' (Desert)?" The old woman became angry and opposed me. So I said, "My example is the example of a sheep that carried its own destruction. I carried this woman and did not know that she was an opponent. I seek refuge with Allah and His Messenger that I become like the emissary of 'Ad.' So the Prophet jg asked me about the emissary of 'Ad, having better knowledge in it, but he liked to hear the story again. I said, "Once, 'Ad suffered from a famine and they sent an emissary [to get relief], whose name was Qayl. Qayl passed by Mu'awiyah bin Bakr and stayed with him for a month. Mu'awiyah supplied him with alcoholic drinks, and two female singers were singing for him. When a month ended, Qayl went to the mountains of Muhrah and said, 'O Allah! You know that I did not come here to cure an ill person or to ransom a prisoner. O Allah! Give 'Ad water as You used to.' So black clouds came and he was called, 'Choose which one of them you wish (to go to 'Ad)! So he pointed to one of the black clouds and he heard someone proclaiming from it. Take it, as ashes that will leave none in 'Ad.' And it has been conveyed to me that the wind sent to them was no more than what would pass through this ring of mine, but it destroyed them." Abu Wa'il said, "That is true. When a man or a woman would send an emissary, they would tell him, 'Do not be like the emissary of 'Ad (bringing disaster and utter destruction to them instead of relief).," Imam Ahmad collected this story in the Musnad At- tn Ahmad 3 :482

99Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(73 - 78) (Part-8) mm sa@ v^Tirmidhi ' recorded jli*jJo ^=>ii) t£jJUjUjjj==£-d ^dsj-ty • ' S' *"'• s >~'S * '\ AilJJ l\jjAjti {^J oi<- U i'dit^ ii Ei.itj gfjVi 4 ^ £>***» ^il4^ <>i Jf}\ 4 1£S V; if £j£ 4\$ fcif ju :w;/j_ii 4;jJJ .4^» >^; »>' •"'s "1 (! *• *1 O'4** C^*i j»*— »' ci/if ju 4 j_J ui \$is .*j ji ^ ijiiij jL*jJ ^1 S* iilli' 'H r- 1** t*Jk ^1 4 ijilifc fcSgjf Sj& 4 ft* b Gjff ^4 4^|r£&~£- j^CilbU o^tilz jlij|LjSj^ WsiKcaPw^ similar wording for it, as did An-Nasal12 ' and Ibn Majah.'3 ' |V*|3 jjIj •- A. < t > >*f #</ J* a=su U 4Jji yJjjfr' ^yLj Alii 4*jb -*iiA p^J>5 02 "4 J^=>t Ujjji iSl. ^k=J A v; Sr ^1 4>o» 473. And to Thamud (people, We sent) their brother Salih. He said : "O my people! Worship Allah! You have ho other god but Him. Indeed there has come to you a clear signfrom your Lord. This she-camel ofAllah is a sign unto you; so you leave her to TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:161. 121 Al-Kubra 5:181. 131 Ibn Mfijah 2 :941

100 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir graze in Allah's earth, and touch her not with harm, lest a painful torment should seize you.) 474. And remember when He made you successors (getierations) after 'Ad and gave you habitations in the land, you build for yourselves palaces in plains, and carve out homes in the mountains. So remember the graces (bestowed upon you) from Allah, and do not go about making mischiefon the earth.) 475. The leaders of those who were arrogant among his people said to those who were counted weak - to such of them as believed: "Know you that Salilt is one sent from his Lord." They said: "We indeed believe in that with which he has been sent.") 476. Those who were arrogant said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that which you believe in.") 477. So they killed the she-camel and insolently defied the commandment of their Lord, and said: "O Salih! Bring about your threats if you are indeed one of the Messengers (of Allah).") 478. So the earthquake seized them, and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.) Thamud: TheirLand and Their Lineage Scholars of Tafsir and genealogy say that (the tribe of ThamQd descended from) ThamCd bin 'Athir bin Iram bin Sam bin Nuh, and he is brother of Jadis son of 'Athir, similarly the tribe of Tasm, and they were from the ancient Arabs, Al-

‘Aribah,*** before the time of Ibrahim, Thamud came after ‘Ad. They dwelled between the area of the Hijaz (Western Arabia) and Ash-Sham (Greater Syria). The Messenger of Allah ﷺ passed by the area and ruins of Thamud when he went to Tabok (in northern Arabia) during the ninth year of Hijrah. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Umar said, “When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ went to the area of Al-Hijr in Tabok with the people, he camped near the homes of Thamud, in Al-Hijr and the people brought water from the wells that Thamud used *** As opposed to Al-Musta‘ribah, such as the descendants of Prophet Ismail, son of Ibrahim

101 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (73 - 78) (Part-8 before. They used that water to make dough and placed the pots (on fire) for cooking. However, the Prophet ﷺ commanded them to spill the contents of the pots and to give the dough to their camels. He then marched forth with them from that area to another area, near the well that the camel (as will follow) used to drink from. He forbade the Companions from entering the area where people were tormented, saying, JJ-jj u jL oiJJ. i J </ fear that what befell them might befall you as well. Therefore, do not enter on them.”¹¹ Ahmad narrated that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said while in the Hijr area, * jgt i JJZ p oii j-si; ol V) Wji JU i ft «Do not enter on these who were tormented, unless you do so while crying. If you are not crying, then do not enter on them, so that what befell them does not befall you, as well.¹² The basis of this Hadith is mentioned in Two Sahih.‘³ The Story of Prophet Salih and Thamud Allah said, 4And to Thamud meaning, to the tribe of Thamud, We sent their brother Salih, 4&AotPt a* ijiiit £> 4He said: “O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him.”⁴ All Allah’s Messengers called to the worship of Allah alone without partners. Allah said in other Ayat. '0 ViAV %a 111 Ahmad 2:117. 121 Ahmad 2 : 74 Path Al-Bari 6 :436 and Muslim 4 :2286.

iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me."} [21:25] and, ii' vuJ 'if-j p,\ ^ lil' verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit (all false deities)" } [16:36]. Thamud asked that a Camel appear from a Stone, and it did Prophet Salih said, 4.“Indeed there has come to you a clear sign from your Lord. This she-camel of Allah is a sign unto you;”} meaning, a miracle has come to you from Allah testifying to the truth of what I came to you with. Salih’s people asked him to produce a miracle and suggested a certain solid rock that they chose, which stood lonely in the area of Hijr, and which was called Al-Katibah. They asked him to bring a pregnant camel out of that stone. Salih took their covenant and promises that if Allah answers their challenge, they would believe and follow him. When they gave him their oaths and promises to that, Salih started praying and invoked Allah (to produce that miracle). All of a sudden, the stone moved and broke apart, producing a she-camel with thick wool. It was pregnant and its fetus was visibly moving in its belly, exactly as Salih’s people asked. This is when their chief, Jundu‘ bin ‘Amr, and several who followed him believed. The rest of the noblemen of Thamud wanted to believe as well, but Dhu‘ab bin ‘Amr bin Labld, Al-Habbab, who tended their idols, and Rabbab bin Sum‘ar bin Jilhis stopped them. One of the cousins of Jundu* bin ‘Amr, whose name was Shihab bin Khalifah bin Mikhlal bin Labld bin Jawwas, was one of the leaders of Thamud, and he also wanted to accept the message. However, the chiefs whom we mentioned prevented him, and he conceded to their promptings. The camel remained in Thamud, as well as, its offspring

203 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (73 - 78) (Part-8) after she delivered it before them. The camel used to drink from its well on one day and leave the well for Thamud the next day. They also used to drink its milk, for on the days she drank water, they used to milk her and fill their containers from its milk. Allah said in other Ayat, *fr**. *sDI iAtid inform thetn* that the water is to be shared between (her and) them , each one's right to drink being established (by turns)} [54:28] and, *fS. Ziri ZiA ^^ iHere is a she-camel : it has a right to drink (water), and you have a right to drink (water) (each) on a day, known}* [26:155] The camel used to graze in some of their valleys, going through a pass and coming out through another pass. She did that so as to be able to move easily, because she used to drink a lot of water. She was a tremendous animal that had a strikingly beautiful appearance. When she used to pass by their cattle, the cattle would be afraid of her. When this matter continued for a long time and Thamud's rejection of Salih became intense, they intended to kill her so that they could take the water for themselves every day. It was said that all of them (the disbelievers of Thamud) conspired to kill the camel. Qatadah said that he was told that, "The designated killer of the camel approached them all, including women in their rooms and children, and found out that all of them agreed to kill her."¹¹¹ This fact is apparent from the wording of the Ayat, *iThen they denied him and they killed it. So their Lord destroyed them because of their sin, and made them equal in destruction!*} [91:14], and, *[foiii \re? iitl' ifo iAnd YJe sent the she-camel to Tltamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong.}* [17:59] ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 12:537.

104 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Allah said here, *iSo they killed the she-camel}* Therefore, these Ayat stated that the entire tribe shared in agreeing to this crime, and Allah knows best. Thamud kills the She-Camel Imam Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir and other scholars of Tafsir said that the reason behind killing the camel was that a disbelieving old woman among them named Umm Ghanm TJnayzah, the daughter of Ghanm bin Mijlaz, had the severest enmity among Thamud towards Salih, peace be upon him. She had beautiful daughters and she was wealthy, and Dhu'ab bin 'Amr, one of the leaders of Thamud, was her husband. There was another noblewoman whose name was Saduf bint Al-Mulayya bin Dahr bin Al-Muhayya, who was of noble family, wealthy and beautiful. She was married to a Muslim man from Thamud, but she left him. These two women offered a prize for those who swore to them that they would kill the camel. Once, Saduf summoned a man called Al-Habbab and offered herself to him if he would kill the camel, but he refused. So she called a cousin of hers whose name was Musaddi* bin Mihraj bin Al-Muhayya, and he agreed. As for TJnayzah bint Ghanm, she called Qudar bin Salif bin Jundu', a short person with red-blue skin, a bastard, according to them. Qudar was not the son of his claimed father, Salif, but the son of another man called, Suhyad. However, he was born on Salif's bed (and thus named after him). TJnayzah said to Qudar, "I will give you any of my daughters you wish, if you kill the camel." Qudar bin Salif and Musaddi* bin Mihraj went along and recruited several mischievous persons from Thamud to kill the camel. Seven more from Thamud agreed, and the group became nine, as Allah described, when He said, *4And there were in the city nine men, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform* These nine men were chiefs of their people, and they lured the entire tribe into agreeing to kill the camel. So they waited

105 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (73 -78) (Part-8 until the camel left the water well, where Qudar waited beside a rock on its path, while Musaddi* waited at another rock. When the camel passed by Musaddi' he shot an arrow at her and the arrow pierced her leg. At that time, TJnayzah came out and ordered her daughter, who was among the most beautiful women, to uncover her face for Qudar, encouraging Qudar

to swing his sword, hitting the camel on her knee. So she fell to the ground and screamed once to warn her offspring. Qudar stabbed her in her neck and slaughtered her. Her offspring went up a high rock and screamed.(1) ‘Abdur- Razzaq recorded from Ma'mar that someone reported from Al- Hasan Al-Basari that the offspring said, “O my Lord! Where is my mother?” It was said that her offspring screamed thrice and entered a rock and vanished in it, or, they followed it and killed it together with its mother. 121 Allah knows best. When they finished the camel off and the news reached Prophet Salih, he came to them while they were gathered. When he saw the camel, he cried and proclaimed, i"Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days."} [1 1:65) The Wicked Ones Plot to Kill Prophet Salih, But the Torment descended on Them The nine wicked persons killed the camel on a Wednesday, and that night, they conspired to kill Salih. They said, “If he is truthful, we should finish him before we are finished. If he is a liar, we will make him follow his camel.” qs^ C \$3 ~ jug i, ^ i^^ <j=L iThey said : "Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household, and thereafter we will surely say to his near relatives: We witnessed not the destruction of his household, and verily, we are telling the truth." So they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while At-Tabari 12:531. ‘Abdur- Razzaq 2 :23 1

they perceived not.} [27:49-50] When they conspired to kill Salih and gathered at night to carry out their plot, Allah, to Whom belongs all might and Who protects His Messengers, rained down stones that smashed the heads of these nine people before the rest of the tribe. On Thursday, the first of the three days of respite, the people woke up and their faces were pale (yellow), just as Prophet Salih had promised them. On the second day of respite, Friday, they woke up and found their faces had turned red. On the third day of the respite, Saturday, they woke up with their faces black. On Sunday, they wore the fragrance of Hanut [the perfume for enshrouding the dead before burial] and awaited Allah’s torment and revenge, we seek refuge with Allah from it. They did not know what will be done to them or how and from where the torment would come. When the sun rose, the Sayhah (loud cry) came from the sky and a severe tremor overtook them from below; the souls were captured and the bodies became lifeless, fall in an hour. 4And they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.} They became dead and lifeless and none among them, whether young, old, male or female, escaped the torment. 1 ’ The scholars of Tafsir said that none from the offspring of Thamud remained, except Prophet Salih and those who believed in him. A disbelieving man called Abu Righal was in the Sacred Area at the time and the torment that befell his people did not touch him. When he went out of the Sacred Area one day, a stone fell from the sky and killed him. ‘Abdur- Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Ismail bin Umayyah said that the Prophet j passed by the gravesite of Abu Righal and asked the Companions if they knew whose grave it was. They said, “Allah and His Messenger know better.” He said, ji Ji U 4Li! Uii i4il Olip 4)1 ^ji- <iL_Li 4)1 jLS 111 At-Tabari 12:534.

*This is the grave of Abu Righal, a man from Thamud. He was in the Sacred Area of Allah and this fact saved him from receiving Allah's torment. When he went out of the Sacred Area, what befell his people also befell him. He was buried here along with a branch made from gold. So the people used their swords and looked for the golden branch and found it. |x| ‘Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma‘mar said that Az-Zuhri said that Abu Righal is the father of the tribe of Thaqif. S# i p Oj 5)1 3 ju;p <79. Then he [Salih] turned from them, and said: "O my people! I have indeed conveyed to you the Message of my Lord, and have given you good advice, but you like not good advisers."> These are the words of

admonishment that Salih conveyed to his people after Allah destroyed them for defying Him, rebelling against Him, refusing to accept the truth, avoiding guidance, and preferring misguidance instead. Salih said these words of admonishment and criticism to them after they perished, and they heard him (as a miracle for Prophet Salih from Allah). Similarly, it is recorded in the Two Sahihs that after the Messenger of Allah sg defeated the disbelievers in the battle of Badr, he remained in that area for three days, and then rode his camel, which was prepared for him during the latter part of the night. He went on until he stood by the well of Badr (where the corpses of the disbelievers were thrown) and said, $\text{u Uj}^* \text{ 9}^{**} \text{ j-}^{\wedge} \text{ If-} \dots - 1 - \text{ uv} \bullet \dots \text{ nX}^{\sim} \text{ V ft, r x}^* \bullet!^{****} \text{ aO Abu Jahl bin Hishdm! O 'Utbah bin Rabbah! O Shaybah bin Rabi'ah! Did you find what your Lord has promised you (of torment) to be true, for I found what my Lord promised me (of }^{***} \text{ 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :232. 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :232}$

victory) to be true. 'Umar said to him, "O Allah's Messenger! Why do you speak to a people who have rotted?" He jg said, $\wedge (4^* \text{ Jyt UJ}$ "By He in Whose Hand is my soul! You do not hear wltat I am saying better than they, but they cannot reply, n11 ! Similarly, Prophet Salih, peace be upon him, said to his people, $\text{ip} \wedge \text{ i}'$ I have indeed conveyed to you the Message ofmy Lord, and have given you good advice,"} but you did not benefit from it because you do not like the Truth and do not follow those who give you sincere advice, $\text{i}^{\text{'}}$ but you like not good advisers."} $\text{i}^{\&\wedge\text{sp}} \text{ \&s in\& ojG i80. And (remember) Lut, when he said to his people: "Do you commit lewdness such as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations?} \text{ ill. "Verily, you practice your lusts on men instead of women. Nay, but you are a people transgressing beyond bounds."} \text{ The Story ofProphet Lut, upon Him be Peace, and His People Allah said, We sent, iji iAtid} \text{ Fath. Al-Bari 7 :351 and Muslim 4 :2204.}$

$\text{iLut, when he said to his people.. Lut (Lot) is the son of Haran the son of Azar (Terah), and he was the nephew of Ibrahim, peace be upon them both. Lut had believed in Ibrahim and migrated with him to the Sham area. Allah then sent Lut to the people of Sadum (Sodom) and the surrounding villages, to call them to Allah, enjoin righteousness and forbid them from their evil practices, their sin, and wickedness. It this area, they did things that none of the children ofAdam or any other creatures ever did before them. They used to have sexual intercourse with males instead of females. This evil practice was not known among the Children ofAdam before, nor did it even cross their minds, so they were unfamiliar with it before the people of Sodom invented it, may Allah's curse be on them. 'Amr bin Dinar commented on; 4". \dots as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations."} "Never before the people of Lut did a male have sex with another male." This is why Lut said to them. 4"Do you commit lewdness such as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations? Verily, you practice your lusts on men instead ofwomen meaning, you left women whom Allah created for you and instead had sex with men? Indeed, this behavior is evil and ignorant because you have placed things in their improper places. Lot, peace be upon him, said to them: $\text{i'crlfi 4 U}^> \text{ ' 4}$ "these (the girls of the nation) are my daughters (to marry lawfully), ifyou must act (so)."} [15:71] So he reminded them of their women, and they replied that they do not desire women!, $\text{111 At-Tabari 12:548.}$$

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir $\wedge \text{ **0}^* \text{ 'jr CiJ \$}$ They said: ",Surely 1/om know that we have neither any desire nor need of your daughters, and indeed you know well what we want!" $\wedge [1 \text{ 1:79}]$ meaning, you know that we have no desire for women and you know what we desire with your guests. $\wedge=\wedge>\}$ ifi $\text{\$}>-\text{* J J-i\&i o- lii \$82. And the answer of his people was only that they said: "Drive them out of your town, these are}$

indeed men who want to be pure (from sins)!”\$ So they answered Prophet Lut by trying to expel and banish him from their village, along with those who believed with him. Allah indeed removed Prophet Lot safely from among them, and He destroyed them in their land in disgrace and humiliation. They said (about Lot and the believers): \$”These are indeed men who want to be pure (from sins)!”} Qatadah commented, “They shamed them (Lut and the *** This refers to the angels who came in the shape of men to destroy them. vJj (iilSJVi(ituswss 1 1 \ * * .tvi O ojJ&y 0 \ S s / -'t-' if t / -1 ff>:r

IllSurah 7. Al-A'rdf (82 - 84) (Part-8 believers) with what is not a shame at all.” ' Mujahid commented, “(Lilt’s people said about Lot and the believers,) They are a people who want to be pure from men’s anuses and women’s anuses!”*2 * Similar was narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas. JJaS £J2^ £*& && Vi ,&1j 453. Then We saved him and his family, except his wife; she was of the Ghdbirin (tlwse who lagged behind).} <84. And We rained down on them a rain (of stones). Then see what was the end of the criminals .} Allah says, We saved Lut and his family, for only his household believed in him. Allah said in another Ayah, ji. \i Cly U i\gjoojii' Si d? S iSo We brought out from therein the believers. But We found not there any household of the Muslims except one [of Lut and his daughters]} [51:35-36]. Only his wife (from his family) did not believe, remaining on the religion of her people. She used to conspire with them against Lot and inform them of who came to visit him, using certain signals that they agreed on. This is why when Lut was commanded to leave by night with his family, he was ordered not to inform his wife or take her with him. Some said that she followed them, and when the torment struck her people, she looked back and suffered the same punishment as them. However, it appears that she did not leave the town and that Lot did not tell her that they would depart. So she remained with her people, as apparent from Allah’s statement, iexcept his wife; she was of the Ghdbirin meaning, of those who remained, or they say: of those who were destroyed, and this is the more obvious explanation. ll At-Jabari 12 :550. ' At-Tabari 12:550. * At-Tabari 12:550.

Allah’s statement, 4And We rained down on them a rain> is explained by His other statement, 0: (j; Silj x£ iipli ^ ^ l|fr i^nd rained on them stones of baked day, in a well-arranged manner one after another. Marked from your Lord; and they are not everfarfrom the wrongdoers.> [1 1:82-83], Allah said here, iThen see what was the etid of the criminals> This Ayah means: ‘See, O Muhammad, the end of those who dared to disobey Allah and reject His Messengers.’ Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, all recorded a Hadlth (from] Ibn ‘Abbas who said that Allah’s Messenger sg said; •Ji 3 ij&ii & ^Whoever is found doing the act of the people of Lut, then kill them; the doer and the one it is done toJ ^ 4 «^ J • ' "V*• <* w« — V o] jj»- 1 4 Ji p ^ 'JJ—r*-' ju \><x % i85. And to (the people of) Madyan, (We sent) their brother Shu'ayb. He said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Verily, a clear proof (sign) from your Lord has come unto you; so give full measure and foil weight and wrong not men in their things, and do not do mischief on the earth after it has been set in order, that will be betterfor you, if 111 Ahmad 1 :300, At-Tirmidhi 1456, Abu Dawud 4462, and Ibn Majah

113Surah 7 . Al-A'raf (85) (Part-8) you are believers.) Story of Shu'ayb, upon him be Peace, and the Land of Madyan Muhammad bin Ishaq said, “They (the people of Madyan) are the descendents of Madyan, son of Midyan, son of Ibrahim. Shu'ayb was the son of Mlkil bin Yashjur. And in the Syrian language, his name was Yathrun (Jethro)”. 1 11 I (Ibn Kathir) say, Madyan was the name of the tribe

and also a city that is close to Ma'an on route to the Hijaz (from Ash-Sham). Allah said in another Ayah, Hi? -M mV UJj> 4And when he arrived at the water (a well) of Madyan he found there a group of men watering (their flocks). (28 :23 They are also the people of Al-Aykah (the Woods), as we will mention later on, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. 4He said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him") and this is the call of all Messengers, ^ s>) 4"Verily, a clear proof (sign) from your Lord has come unto you;" meaning, 'Allah has presented the proof and evidences of the truth of what I brought you.' He then advised them and commanded them to give full measure and full weight and not to wrong men in their dealings, meaning, to refrain from cheating people in buying and selling. They used to treacherously avoid giving full weight and measure. Allah said in other Ayat, 4Woe to Al-Mutaffflin (those who give less in measure and weight)... [83 : 1] m At-Tabari 12:554.

until He said, 4.U£>' ibefore the Lord of all that exists?} [83:6], These Aydt contain a stern warning and sure promise that we ask Allah to save us from. Shu'ayb was called 'Speaker of the Prophets', because of his eloquent words and eloquent advice, and Allah stated that Shu'ayb said: •ii O* \$ Jyf- JjXc-j ijju W fs*d&u h ism;U> taws i^si; J »}j c-is-jl tfjil oIT jJj *y .vi -iil> 486. "And sit not on every road, threatening, and hindering from the path of Allah those who believe in Him, and seeking to make it crooked. And remember when you were but few, and He multiplied you. And see what was the end of the mischief- maker\$. \$ 487. ", And if there is a party of you who believes in that with which I have been sent and a party who does not believe, so be patient until Allah judges between us, and He is the best of judges/> Prophet Shu'ayb forbade his people from setting up blockades on the roads, saying, 4fi/sc.y 4"And sit not on every road, threatening threatening people with death if they do not give up their money, as they were bandits, according to As-Suddi.m Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and several others commented: 4ojX?y 4^=4 4"And sit not on every road, threatening the believers who come to Shu'ayb to follow him."121 The first meaning is better, because Prophet Shu'ayb first said to them, At-Tabari 12:557. At-Tabari 12:557.

4"on every road. .."} He then mentioned the second meaning, 4"and hindering from the path of Allah those who believe in Him, and seeking to make it crooked."} meaning, you seek to make the path of Allah crooked and deviated. 4"And remember when you were but few, and He multiplied you."} meaning, you were weak because you were few. But you later on became mighty because of your large numbers. Therefore, remember Allah's favor. 4U^ 4"And see what was the end of the mischief-makers."} from the previous nations and earlier generations. See the torment and punishment they suffered, because they disobeyed Allah and rejected His Messengers. Shu'ayb continued; 4"And if there is a party of you who believes in that with which I have been sent and a party who does not believe,"} that is, if you divided concerning me, 4"so be patient"} that is, then wait and see, 4"until Allah judges between us,"}, and you, 4<*&i£%} 4"and He is the best of judges."} Surely, Allah will award the best end to those who fear and obey Him and He will destroy the disbelievers.

J mm nr V :.* U^CLmi'C/jl I ^LJUUA^ jljt ilij(j^S/l^i Juoj^jl*j bjj£ij_l<y ^igfeUJh*^ |j^| uj_r~^4 'aI^- *}.l.4»- •• c^^ d?; \$^u^yi; \$ i^yr yj.^1»»JlSS cuawaij(Jjvikiy|^s=l*iljt ?0&s&&)\$&k^&xw ^ijisji^^^jio^ui; He said: "Even though we hate it?"} iw&it y> *o ju >-!;Jl) 4-^ .> r> >^» 4 T'->* 'i ;>vo^O j» Uijy ^ du« CT jJt Jli U.jL ^ tli jt C^ ?af & &y>l ji 44 *it 4f< m j4 (^=uL. j J JyO J UJ j£4 ty j^pi j^ liy ty iil l2j U\$35 jJit ^ llic >.' '1' ;^If , ' <• .— -{• C-'j vj»JU U*j»> |>JJ 4^0*5^ 488. Tire

chiefs of those who were arrogant among his people said: "We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb and those who have believed with you from our town, or else you (all) shall return to our religion." 489. "We should have invented a lie against Allah if we returned to your religion, after Allah has rescued us from it. And it is not for us to return to it unless Allah, our Lord, should will. Our Lord comprehends all things in His knowledge. In Allah (Alone) we put our trust. Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth, for You are the best of those who give judgment."} Allah describes the way the disbelievers answered His Prophet Shu'ayb and those who believed in him, by threatening them with expulsion from their village, or with forceful reversion to the disbeliever's religion. The chiefs spoke the words mentioned here to the Messenger Shu'ayb, but intended it for those who followed his religion too. The statement,

"Even though we hate it?", means, would you force us to do that, even though we hate what you are calling us to? Certainly if we revert to your religion and accept your ways, we will have uttered a tremendous lie against Allah by calling partners as rivals to Him, & it is not for us to return to it unless Allah, our Lord, should will.} This part of the Ayah refers all matters to Allah's will, and certainly, He has perfect knowledge of all matters and His observation encompasses all things, In Allah (Alone) we put our trust., concerning all our affairs, what we practice of them and what we ignore, Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth} judge between us and our people and give us victory over them, for You are the best of those who give judgment} and You are the Most Just Who never wrongs any in His judgment. The chiefs of those who disbelieved among his people said (to their people) : "If you follow Shu'ayb, be sure then you will be the losers!"} 491. So the earthquake seized them and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.} 492. Those who belied Shu'ayb, became as if they had never

"So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!"} [26:187], Therefore, Allah stated that each of these forms of punishment struck them on the Day of the Shadow. First, the torment of the Day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud) seized them} (26:189) when a gloomy cloud came over them (containing) fire, flames and a tremendous light. Next, a cry from the sky descended on them and a tremor shook them from beneath. Consequently, their souls were captured, their lives were taken and their bodies became idle, and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes}. Allah said next, They became as if they had never dwelt time} meaning, after the torment seized them, it looked as if they never dwelled in the land from which they wanted to expel their Messenger Shu'ayb and his followers. Here, Allah refuted their earlier statement, Those who belied Shu'ayb, they were the losers.} Then he (Shu'ayb) turned from them and said: "O my people! I have indeed conveyed my Lord's Messages unto you and I have given you good advice. Then how can I grieve over people who are disbelievers."} Prophet Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, turned away from his people after the torment, punishment and destruction struck them, admonishing and censuring them by saying to them,

"O my people! I have indeed conveyed my Lord's Messages unto you and I have given you good advice."} Shu'ayb said, I have conveyed to you what I was sent with, so I will not feel any sorrow for you since you disbelieved in what I brought you, & Then how can I grieve over people who are disbelievers?"} & We sent no Prophet unto any town (and they

denied him), but We seized its people with Ba'sd' and Darrd', so that they might humble themselves (to Allah).} 495. Then We changed the evil for the good, until they 'Afa (increased), and said: "Our fathers were touched with evil and with good." So We seized them all of a sudden while they were unaware.} Afflictions that struck Earlier Nations Allah mentions the Ba'sd and Darrd' that struck the earlier nations to whom He sent Prophets. Ba'sd', refers to the physical sicknesses and ailments that they suffered, while Darra', refers to the poverty and humiliation that they experienced, 4Z>s& 4so tlrt they might humble themselves} supplicate, humble themselves and invoke Allah, that He might remove the afflictions that they suffered from. This Ayah indicates that Allah sent down severe afflictions to them so that they might invoke Him, but they did not do what He ordered them. Therefore, He changed the affliction into prosperity to test them, ass Gil; ?} 4Then We clunged the evil for the good,} f tty oilm ££ igaij zyg Or >

121 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (94 - 95) (Part-9) Therefore, Allah changed the hardship into prosperity, disease and sickness into health and well-being, and poverty into richness in provision, so that they might be thankful to Allah for this, but they did none of that. Allah's statement, inntil they 'Afawi refers to increase in numbers, wealth and offspring. Allah said next, 4^21 '£*£> fcfy; ^2 ji ijSsj^ i and they said: "Our fathers were touched with evil and with good." So We seized them all of a sudden while they were unaware> He tested them with this (afflictions) and that (ease and abundance) so that they may humble themselves and repent to Him. However, they failed both tests, for neither this nor that compelled them to change their ways. They said, "We suffered Ba'sa' and Darra\ but prosperity came afterwards, just as like our forefathers in earlier times." "Therefore," they said, "it is a cycle where we sometimes suffer a hardship and at other times, we enjoy a bounty." However, they did not comprehend Allah's wisdom, nor the fact that He is testing them in both cases. To the contraiy, the believers are grateful to Allah in good times and practice patience in hard times. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith that says; fja oLii j\j nJ \Jj- JLS N\ iLai «j iot V \y£ ilia '/l 3 i'js. b 11The matter of the believer is amazing, for nothing that Allah decrees for him, but it is better for him . If a Darrd' (harm) strikes him, he is patient, and this is better for him, if he is given Sana' (prosperity), he thanks (Alldlt) for it and this is betterfor him .»[1] The believer, therefore, is aware of the test behind the m Muslim 4 :2295.

123 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (96 - 99) (Part-9 * *Lt &L3 £ JS (LIV rfet J aCsK Jity jl J53T% -if & 496. And if the people of the towns had believed and had Taqwa, certainly. We should have opened for them blessings from the heaven and the earth, but they belied (the Messengers) . So We took them (with punishment) for what they used to earn.} 497. Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep?} 496. Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} 499. Did they then feel secure against Allah's plan? None feels secure from Allah's plan except the people who are the losers.} Blessings come with Faith, while Kuf brings Torment Allah mentions here the little faith of the people of the towns to whom He sent Messengers. In another instance, Allah said, *3* S->j. ft vine kJ} 2% yj&} 0jlt 4 4W«s there any town (community) that believed (after seeing the punishment), and its faith (at that moment) saved it (from the punishment)? - Except the people of Yunus; when they believed, We removed from them the torment of disgrace in the life of the (present) world,,and permitted them to enjoy for a while.} [10:98] This Ayah indicates that no city believed in its entirety, except the city of Prophet YQnus, for they all believed after they were stricken by punishment.

Allah said (about Prophet Yunus), } And We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more. And they believed; so We gave them enjoyment for a while.} [37:147-148]

Allah said in another Ayah, J* f&j 4 'to iAtid We did not send a Warner to a township ... [34:34] Allah said here, imi\& 3to 4And if the people of the towns had believed and had Taqwa...} meaning their hearts had faith in what the Messenger brought them, believed and obeyed him, and had Taqwa by performing the acts of obedience and abstaining from the prohibitions, 4u?jV?j ££& Si 4We should have opened for them blessings from the heaven and the earth,} in reference to the rain that falls from the sky and the vegetation of the earth. Allah said, 4'oJJZ Cj &} ibut they belied (the Messengers). So We took them (with punishment) for what they used to earn.} They denied their Messengers, so that We punished them and sent destruction on them as a result of the sins and wickedness that they earned. Allah then said, while warning and threatening against defying His orders and daring to commit His prohibitions, 4'Jti 32i\$} 4Did the people of the towns then feel secure}, meaning the disbelievers among them, rfet to ithat should come to them our punishment}, Our torment and punishing example. iBayatan} during the night, j*A> ci'-' (> <:ji J tSjild jit ofSi ^J>j}

125 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (99 - 100) (Part-9) iivhile they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} while they are busy in their affairs and unaware. 4\$ \y^j\} 4Did they then feel secure against Allah's plan?} His torment, vengeance, and His power to destroy them while they are inattentive and heedless, fjil' iNone feels secure from Allah's plan except the people who are the losers .} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "The believer performs the acts of worship, all the while feeling fear, in fright and anxiety. The Fdjir (wicked sinner, or disbeliever) commits the acts of disobedience while feeling safe (from Allah's torment)!" o* Hi 5\$} 4®^ v^^£ |< | \ ,n\ »L-J y O' 4100. Is it not a guidance for those who inherit the earth from its previous inhabitants that had We willed, We would have punished them for their sins. And We seal up their hearts so that they hear not?} Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4^^^U& >>. Hi jfy 4ls it not a guidance for those who inherit the earth from its previous inhabitants...} "(Allah says,) did We not make clear to them that had We willed, We would have punished them because of their sins?" Mujahid and several others said similarly. 111 Abu Ja'far bin Jarir At-Tabari explained this Ayah, "Allah says, 'Did We not make clear to those who succeeded on the earth after destroying the previous nations who used to dwell in that land. Then they followed their own ways, and behaved as they did and were unruly with their Lord. [Did We not make clear m At-Tabari 12 :580

to them] that, ithat had We willed, We would have punished them for their sins.} by bringing them the same end that was decreed for those before them. iAnd We seal up their hearts}, We place a cover over their heart, ^so that they hear not}, words of advice or reminding?" • I say that similarly, Allah said, JjV yfoj kiU'j j jj 4 Cy/) ' r&j L 'p 1 ^A ""* " ils it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them, in whose dwellings they walk? Verily, in this are signs indeed for men of understanding.} [20:128] 4 5} 4 *5 Si 4 p pi '» py^ ils it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they do walk about? Verily, therein indeed are signs. Would they not then listen?} [32:26] and, } Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter). And you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves} [14A4-45] Also, Allah said. j'P Si J* J>& && pf} m At-Tabari 12:579.

227Siirah 7. Al-A'raf (102) (Part-9) 4And how many a generation before them have We destroyed! Can you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?} [19:98] meaning, do you see any of them or hear their voices? There are many other Ayat that testify that Allah's torment strikes His enemies, while His bounty reaches His faithful believers. Thereafter comes Allah's statement, and He is the Most Truthful, the Lord of all that exists, KLi Cj i2j ^ it css Cj && 'j4 o* ife 4 .' *V. ::^l .>*a£==*1 bJu.j 4202 . 77iose were the towns whose story We relate unto you. And there came indeed to them their Messengers with clear proofs, but tlthey were not such who would believe in what they rejected before. Thus Allah does seal up the hearts of the disbelievers.} 4202. And most of them Wefound not true to their covenant, but most ofthem Wefound indeed rebellious.} After narrating the stories of the people of Prophets Nuh, Hud, Salih, Lut and Shu'ayb, destroying the disbelievers, saving the believers, warning these nations by explaining the truth to them with the evidence sent in the words of His Messengers, may Allah's peace and blessings be on them all, Allah said; 4J& &,) iTlwse were the towns that We relate to you} O Muhammad, 4their story}, and news, 4v£Jt ,#5 (2* Z'fo 4And there came indeed to them their Messengers with clear proofs,} and evidences of the truth of what they brought them. Allah said in other Ayah,

128 Tafsir Ibtī Katlur iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).} [17: 15J, and, l>* & &C3 <hljj} iThat is some of the news of the towns which We relate unto you ; of them, some are standing, and some have been reaped. We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves.} [11 :100-101 Allah said ^ l>i£l ibut they were not such who would believe in what they had rejected before.} meaning they would not have later on believed in what the Messengers brought them, because they denied the truth when it first came to them (although they recognized it), according to the Tafsir of Ibn 'Atiyyah. This explanation is sound, and is supported by Allah's statement, iAnd what will make you perceive that if it came, they will not believe? And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes axvay (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time.} [6:109-1 10] This is why Allah said here, ty «_yl» if Sit iThus Allah does seal up the hearts of the disbelievers. And most ofthan Wefound not...} meaning, We did not find most of the previous nations, ^uAi—^ HiJwj Xf£-^} ittrue to their covenant, but most of them We found to indeed be rebellious.}

This Ayah means, We found most of them to be rebellious, deviating away from obedience and compliance. The covenant mentioned here is the Fitrah that Allah instilled in them while still in their fathers' loins, and taking their covenant, that He is their Lord, King, and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him,. They affirmed this covenant and testified against themselves to this fact. However, they defied this covenant, threw it behind their backs and worshipped others besides Allah, having no proof or plea, nor support from rationality or by divine law. Surely, the pure Fitrah defies these actions, while all the honorable Messengers, from beginning to end, forbade them. Muslim collected the Hadith, if c_iU- ^1 ill JjZj ' i m* t I- * *T ; ' ' "Allah said, "1 created My servants Hunafa' (monotheists), but the devils came to than and deviated them from their religion and prohibited them what I allowed than."« ll] It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, «jl ol^ili Jl j djJ JS1 *Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, it is only his parents wlv turn him into a Jew, a Christian or a Zoroastrian jJaiS \ dj, fesis* j. GZ 4 '•''' .it-i .-Sii? 4103. Then after than We sent Musa with Our signs to Fir'awn and his chiefs, but they wrongfully rejected than. So see how was the end of the mischief-makers} Story

of Prophet Musa, upon him be Peace, and Fir'awn Allah said, U GZ ?} 111 Muslim 4:2197. Path Al-Bari3 :290 and Muslim 4 :2047.

130 Tafsir Ibn Kathir nmm \m Ji&S\ jcjjjVvul 0Si 'Sjo^ojtjrc&/j&ci^ . ^y_5 cJ^j*O^-aJc^liU dL^ac-^tiJ\ 4yfc0£^i£.gj}juJuiJ-jV»*U-t>i*\$9^ ©E36“ %^iThert after them We sent}, after the Messengers whom We mentioned, such as Nakh, Hud, Salih Ldt and Shu'ayb (may Allah's peace and blessings be on them and the rest of Allah's Prophets), We sent, 4C^lL frji} iMusa with Our signs> proofs and clear evidences, to Fir'awn, who was ruler of Egypt during the time of Musa, i'ipjb {and his chiefs> the people of Fir'awn, ibut they wrongfully rejected them}, they denied and disbelieved in the signs, out of injustice and stubbornness on their part. Allah said about them in another Ayah, jJbB Ob X&\$Xj \$ ijZZ# U lit o ' li ijLil LLJi[jiJ \jU^ 6^3 ^And they belied them (those Aydt) wrongfully and arrogantly, though they were themselves convinced thereof. So see wlm was the end of the evildoers.>(27: 14] The Ayah says, 'those who hindered from the path of Allah and belied in His Messengers, look how We punished them, We caused them to drown, all of them, while Musa and his people were watching.' Public drowning added disgrace to the punishment that Fir'awn and his people suffered, while adding comfort to the hearts of Allah's party, Musa and those people

131 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (104 - 106) (Part-9) who believed in him. if Jy' V J jje Jj-o 4l 'n' 4^1 ' : A v i : "s' if c-a 4 Jt» in •** o^ cn 4r 4104. And Miisa said: "O Fir'awn! Verily, I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists."} 4105. "Proper it is for me that I say nothing concerning Allah but the truth. Indeed I have come unto you from your Lord with a clear proof. So let the Children of Israel depart along with me."} [Fir'awn] said: "If you have come with a sign, show it forth, if you are one of those who tell the truth."} Allah mentions a debate that took place between Musa and Fir'awn, and Musa's refuting Fir'awn with the unequivocal proof and clear miracles, in the presence of Fir'awn and his people, the Copts of Egypt. Allah said, 4And Musa said : "O Fir'awn! Verily, I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists".} meaning Musa said, 'the one Who sent me is the Creator, Lord and King of all things,' iJeJ' \$M£ Jy' V J if 4"Proper it is for me that I say nothing concerning Allah but the truth."} It is incumbent and a duty for me to convey only the Truth from Him, because of what I know of His might and power.' iftij in 4"Indeed I have come unto you from your Lord with a clear proof."} 1 brought unequivocal evidence that Allah gave me to prove that I am conveying the truth to you,' 4"So let the Children of Israel depart along with me." }

means, release them from your slavery and subjugation. Let them worship your Lord and their Lord. They are from the offspring of an honorable Prophet, Isra'il, who is Ya'qub son of Ishaq son of Ibrahim, the Khalil (intimate friend) of Allah. 4 Ol *— *^ ^)J If? ulj 4[Fir'awn] said: "If you have come with a sign, show it forth, if you are one of those who tell the truth."} Fir'awn said, *1 will not believe in what you have said nor entertain your request'. Therefore, he said, 'if you have proof, then produce it for us to see, so that we know if your claim is true.' il07. Then [Musa] threw his staff and behold! it was a [Thu'bdn] serpent, manifest!} 4108. And he drew out his hand, and behold! it was white (with radiance) for the beholders.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4a [Thu'bdn] serpent, manifest}, refers to "The male snake." As- Suddi and Ad-Dahhak said similarly.12 ' A report from Ibn 'Abbas said, 4'^ "4Then (Musa) threw his staff}, and it turned into a huge snake that opened its mouth and rushed towards Fir'awn. When Fir'awn saw the snake rushing

towards him, he jumped from his throne and cried to Musa for help, so that Musa would remove the snake from his way. Musa did that.”¹³, As-Suddi commented, *ian.i behold! It was a [Tlw'bdn] serpent, manifest!*) At-Jabari 13:16. 121 At-Jabari 13:15-17. ;3) At-Taban 13:16.

133 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (107 - 110) (Part-9) “This [Thu'ban] refers to male snakes. The snake opened its mouth and headed towards Fir'awn to swallow him, placing its lower jaw on the ground and its upper jaw reaching the (top of the) wall of the palace. When Fir'awn saw the snake, he was frightened, so he jumped and wet himself and he never wet himself before this incident. He cried, ‘O Musa! Take it away and I will believe in you and release the Children of Israel to you.’ So MQsa, peace be on him, took it, and it became a staff again.” 4 ' JI 'i)i VSi {fj} 4 And he drew out his hand, and behold! it was white (with radiance) far the beholders.} Musa took his hand out of his cloak after he inserted his hand in it and it was shining, not because of leprosy or sickness. Allah said in another Ayah, *T » “ /w o r/ , '«/ r V i And put your hand into your bosom, it will come forth white without hurt.} (27:12] Ibn ‘Abbas said, “without hurt’, means, ‘not because of leprosy’. Musa inserted his hand again in his sleeve and it returned back to its normal color.”*2 ' Mujahid and several others said similarly.*3 liCi <'* -ty. oj Cfi Stll' 4109. The chiefs of the people of Fir'awn said: "This is indeed a well-versed sorcerer."} 4110. "He wants to get you out of your land, so what do you advise?"} Fir'awn's People say that Musa is a Magician! The chiefs and noblemen of the people of Fir'awn agreed with Fir'awn's statement about Musa. After Fir'awn felt safe and At-Tabari 13:15. ' At-Jabari 13:17. ' At-Tabari 13:18.

136 Tafsir Ibn Kathir into them, and they displayed a great trick.} The magicians challenged Mitsa, when they said, 0^3 o' Utj {j dj J lil' i Either you throw (first), or shall we have the (first) throw?} before you. In another Ayah, they said, i Or we be the first to throw} [20:65]. Musa said to them, you throw first. It was said that the wisdom behind asking them to throw first, is that - Allah knows best - the people might witness the magicians' sorcery first. When the magicians had cast their spell and captured the eyes, the clear and unequivocal truth came, at a time when they all anticipated and waited for it to come, thus making the truth even more impressive to their hearts. This is what happened. Allah said, ^ oasas no stssiga ^ 4ii1 aS-u!'j Jlijs^} } "A/ </ // . // A//'' • i* . Jjjoj^ 1j 0-* 4iU_jLo_ll La A—tijjf , *1 r? -- *>. ^ »> c^fj j » <j p-r-s^,4UvT^j o> < 9'A' ^ *'< o^io-fp v . a* ^ Ijpl ^ (j^A>jQU-mJI o-ujij ij^L. ipji uii> 4 So when they threw, they bewitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them,} meaning, they deceived the eyes and made them think that that trick was real, when it was only an illusion, just as Allah said,

237 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (U6 - 222) (Part-9) .;> ' i " mis-y l j 1 1-'-r» L. yJuJ 4 So Miisa conceived fear in himself. We (Allah) said: "Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand. And throw that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain" } [20:67-69]. Ibn ‘Abbas commented that the magicians threw, “Thick ropes and long sticks, and they appeared to be crawling, an illusion that they created with their magic.” £ jh>j £»y Ji 'i]£ tj) ' J lyy ill] ILL ij)S tjf'i L4-*5 .'V1 iyy vj y-4 4217. And We revealed to Musa (saying): "Throw your stick," and behold! It swallowed up straight away all the falsehood which they showed.} 4223. Thus truth was confirmed, and all that they did was made of no effect.} 4229. So they were defeated there and returned disgraced.} 4120. And the sorcerers fell down prostrate.} 4222. They said: "We believe in the Lord of all

that exists.} 4222. "The Lord of Musa and Harun."} Musa defeats the Magicians, Who believe in Him Allah states that at that tremendous moment, in which Allah differentiated between Truth and Falsehood, He sent a revelation to His servant and Messenger Musa, peace be upon him, ordering him to throw the stick that he held in his right hand, it swallowed straight away} and devoured, 111 At-Tabari 13:28.

4'o j& C) i all the falsehood which they showed.) the magic that they caused the illusion with, of magic with which they caused making it appear real, whereas it was not real at all. Ibn 'Abbas said that Mdsa's stick swallowed all the ropes and sticks that the magicians threw. The magicians realized that this was from heaven and was by no means magic. They fell in prostration and proclaimed, i fry 4>j &L) 4'We believe in the Lord of all that exists. The Lord of Musa and Harun). Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, "It followed the ropes and sticks one after another, until nothing that the sorcerers threw remained. Mdsa then held it in his hand, and it became a stick again just as it was before. The magicians fell in prostration and proclaimed, *We believe in the Lord of all that exists, the Lord of Mdsa and Harun. Had Musa been a magician, he would not have prevailed over us.'"111 Al-Qasim bin Abi Bazzah commented, "Allah revealed to MOsa to throw his stick. When he threw his stick, it became a huge, manifest snake that opened its mouth and swallowed the magicians' ropes and sticks. On that, the magicians fell in prostration. They did not reuse their heads before seeing the Paradise, the Fire, and the recompense of their inhabitants." [2) Vt 6# 4&& & Sih oSC £ 4123. Fir'awn said: "You have believed in him [Musa] before I gave you permission. Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people, but you shall come to know/") 111 At-Tabari 13:30. At-Tabari 13:30.

239 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf d23 - 126) (Part-9 4224. "Surely, I will cut off your hands and your feet from opposite sides, then I will crucify you all."} 4225. They said: "Verily , we are returning to our Lord."} 4226. "And you take vengeance on us only because we believed in the Aydt of our Lord when they reached us! Our Lord! pour out on us patience, and cause us to die as Muslims."} Fir'awn threatens the Magicians after They believed in Musa and Their Response to Him Allah mentions the threats that the Fir'awn - may Allah curse him - made to the magicians after they believed MUsa, peace be upon him, and the deceit and cunning that Fir'awn showed the people. Fir'awn said, ft8^u* i&& S3& tfr i Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people,} meaning Fir'awn proclaimed, *Musa's defeating you today was because you plotted with him and agreed to that.' Fir'awn also said, <5#pz 4He (Musa) is your chief who has taught you magic.} [20:71) However, Fir'awn and all those who had any sense of reason knew for sure that what Fir'awn said was utterly false. As soon as MQsa came from Madyan, he called Fir'awn to Allah and demonstrated tremendous miracles and clear proofs for the Truth that he brought. Fir'awn then sent emissaries to various cities of his kingdom and collected magicians who were scattered throughout Egypt. Fir'awn and his people chose from them, summoned them, and Fir'awn promised them great rewards. These magicians were very eager to prevail over MCKsa in front of Fir'awn, so that they might become closer to him. Mttsa neither knew any of them nor saw or met them before. Fir'awn knew that, but he claimed otherwise to deceive the ignorant masses of his kingdom, just as Allah described them,

iTIus lie [Fir'awrt] fooled his people, and they obeyed him.) [43:54] Certainly, a people who believed Fir'awn in his statement, i"I am your lord, most high.") [79:24], are among the most ignorant and

misguided creatures of Allah. In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, and several other Companions, commented, "Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city..." "Musa met the leader of the magicians and said to him, 'If I defeat you, will you believe in me and bear witness that what I brought is the truth?' The magician said, 'Tomorrow, I will produce a type of magic that cannot be defeated by another magic. By Allah! If you defeat me, I will believe in you and testify to your truth.' Fir'awn was watching them, and this is why he said what he said." His statement, "to drive out its people", means, so that you all cooperate to gain influence and power, replacing the chiefs and masters of this land. In this case, power in the state will be yours, "but you shall come to know", what I will do to you. He then explained his threat, "Surely, I will cut off your hands and your feet from opposite sides" by cutting the right hand and the left leg or the opposite, "then I will crucify you all." just as he said in another Ayah, At-Jabari 13:33.

Surah 7. Al-A'raf (123 - 126) (Part-9 "Fi the trunks of date palms") [20:71], FT in this Ayah means "on". Ibn 'Abbas said that Fir'awn was the first to crucify and cut off hands and legs on opposite sides. The magicians said, "Verily, we are returning to our Lord." They said, "We are now sure that we will go back to Allah. Certainly, Allah's punishment is more severe than your punishment and His torment for what you are calling us to, this day, and the magic you forced us to practice, is greater than your torment. Therefore, we will observe patience in the face of your punishment today, so that we are saved from Allah's torment." They continued, "Our Lord! pour out on us patience", with your religion and being firm in it, "and cause us to die as Muslims.", as followers of Your Prophet Musa, peace be upon him. They also said to Fir'awn, "So decide whatever you desire to decree, for you can only decide for the life of this world. Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faults, and the magic to which you did compel us. And Allah is better [to reward] and more lasting [in punishment]. Verily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal, then surely, far him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live. But whoever comes to Him (Allah) as a believer, and has done righteous good deeds, far such are the high ranks (in the Hereafter)." [20:72-75]. The magicians started the day as sorcerers and ended as honorable martyrs! Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ubayd bin 'Umayr, Qatadah At-Tabari 13:34.

and Ibn Jurayj commented, "They started the day as sorcerers and ended it as martyrs." The chiefs of Fir'awn's people said: "Will you leave Musa and his people to spread mischief in the land, and to abandon you and your gods?" He said: "We will kill their sons, and let their women live, and we have indeed irresistible power over them." 4228. Musa said to his people: "Seek help in Allah and be patient. Verily, the earth is Allah's. He gives it as a heritage to whom He wills of His servants; and the (blessed) end is for the pious and righteous persons." 4229. They said: "We suffered troubles before you came to us, and since you have come to us." He said: "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you act?" Fir'awn vows to kill the Children of Israel, Who complain to Musa; Allah promises Them Victory Allah mentions the conspiracy of Fir'awn and his people, their ill intentions and their hatred for Musa and his people. The chiefs of Fir'awn's people said, to Fir'awn, "Will you leave Musa and his people",

will you let them be free, 4c?:Vt j [>1Jfi} 4"to spread mischief in the land"}, spreading unrest among your m At-Tabari 13:36.

143 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (127 - 129) (Part-9) subjects and calling them to worship their Lord instead of you? Amazingly, these people were worried that Musa and his people would cause mischief. Rather, Fir'awn and his people are the mischief-makers, but they did not realize it. They said, 4"and to abandon you and your gods?"} •Your gods', according to Ibn 'Abbas, as As-Suddi narrated from him, "Were cows. Whenever they saw a beautiful cow, Fir'awn would command them to worship it. This is why As-Samiri, made the statue of a calf that seemed to moo for the Children of Israel."11 ' Fir'awn accepted his people's recommendation, saying, 4"YJe will kill their sons, and let their women live"} thus reiterating his previous order concerning the Children of Israel. He had tormented them (killing every newly born male) before MUsa was born, so that MUsa would not live. However, the opposite of what Fir'awn sought and intended occurred. The same end struck Fir'awn that he intended to subjugate and humiliate the Children of Israel with. Allah gave victory to the Children of Israel, humiliated and disgraced Fir'awn, and caused him to drown along with his soldiers. When Fir'awn insisted on his evil plot against the Children of Israel, h&& *3 try ^Miisa said to his people: "Seek help in Allah and be patient"} and promised them that the good end will be theirs and that they will prevail, saying, oi i"Verily, the earth is Allah's. He gives it as a heritage to whom He wills of His servants; and the (blessed) end is for the pious and righteous persons." They said: "We suffered troubles 111 At-Jabari 13:38.

before you came to us, and since you have come to us The Children of Israel replied to Musa, "they (Fir'awn and his people) inflicted humiliation and disgrace on us, some you witnessed, both before and after you came to us, O Musa! Musa replied, reminding them of their present situation and how it will change in the future, o' 4"It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy..."} encouraging them to appreciate Allah when the afflictions are removed and replaced by a bounty. s mm ^ 1t4_iJ,>*J jSu fe '* 1*4-* ' _>!Uj ills (vn),W-ll C^fi» IT^«*j J-j j£5t/ -t "{,•> I''' -*>'<' > *.•.*' •— IjgSJ 'y'- ==>'y'J .*U_j»_) v. • j *— -*-*»W '*)* Oj~Jl ojfi^i JI* U-ii.1 xilj^ &SJ ^ i*^ £) Vi ,ll: ^ 14^ ^ oii 4& U \)6 4130. And indeed We punished the people of Fir'awn with years of drought and lack of fruits (crops), that they might remember (take heed).} 4131. But whenever good came to them, they said: "This is far us." And if evil afflicted them, they considered it an omen about Musa and those with him. Be informed! Verily, their omens are with Allah but most of them know not.}

145 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (130 - 131) (Part-9) Fir'awn and His People suffer Years of Drought Allah said, 4And indeed We punished the people of Fir'awn We tested and tried them, i with years of drought) offamine due to little produce, 4and lack of fruits), which is less severe, according to Mujahid. * Abu Ishaq narrated that Raja' bin Haywah said, "The date tree used to produce only one date!" (2))That they might remember (take heed). But whenever good came to them) such as a fertile season and provisions, Q \)Z) 4they said, "This is for us."), because we deserve it, U& 4and if evil afflicted them) drought and famine, (>'S " ' > (>'V' 4they considered it an omen Musa and those with him.) saying that this hardship is because of them and what they have done. 4Verily, their omens are with Allah) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, At-Tabari 13:46. 121 At-Tabari 13:46.

146 Tafstr Ibn Kathir xi~ \2[4Verily, their omens are with Allah} “Allah says that their afflictions are with and from Him, 4but most ofthem know not.} jjijij uU Hi (J. £^L2j fX, j* ^ £ tf; ^ *y: \%%&& \$sn; #.t; Z& css. ci*r oi 3i*v c igj ag ijii 5^t c£2- csf ^ su; a ^ <^n ^332 . They said [to Musa] : "Whatever Ayat you may bring to us, to work therewith your sorcery on us, we shall never believe in you."} 4133. So We sent on them: the Tufan, the locusts, the Qummal, the frogs, and the blood (as a succession of) manifest signs, yet they remained arrogant, and they were of those people who were criminals.} 4134. And when the punishment struck them, they said: "O Musa! Invoke your Lord for us because of His promise to you Ifyou remove the punishmentfrom us, we indeed shall believe in you, and we shall let the Children ofIsrael go with you."} 4135. But when We removed the punishment from them for a fixed term, which they had to reach, behold! They broke their word!} Allah punishes the People of Flr'awn because of Their Rebellion Allah describes the rebellion, tyranny, defiance of the truth and insistence on falsehood of the people of Fir'awn, prompting them to proclaim, Ill Ip .yb 1^3 ill At-Tabari 13:48.

147Surah 7. Al-A'raf (132 - 135) (Part-9) 'Whatever Aydt you may bring to us, to work therewith your sorcery on us, we shall never believe in you.'\$ They said, “whatever miracle, proof and evidence you bring us, we will neither accept it from you nor believe in you or what you came with.’ Allah said, 4So We sent on them the Tufan Ibn ‘Abbas commented; “It was a heavy rain that ruined the produce and fruits.” He is also reported to have said that Tuwfdn refers to mass death. MujeLhid said it is water that carries the plague every where. As for the locust, it is the well- known insect, which is permissible to eat. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, that Abu Ya“ftlr said that he asked ‘Abdullah bin Abi Awfa about locust. He said, “We participated in seven battles with the Messenger of All&h jg, and we used to eat locusts.”111 Ash-Shafit, Ahmad bin Hanbal and Ibn Majah recorded from ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam that his father narrated from Ibn “Umar that the Prophet jg said, j o^xll :jUSj jCl* U iWe were allowed two dead animals and two [kinds of] blood: fish and locust, and kidney and spleen . »|a| Ibn Abi Najlh narrated from Mujahid about Allah’s statement, 4So We sent on them: theflood, the locusts ...^ “Eating the nails on their doors and leaving the wood.”13, As for the Qummal, Ibn ‘Abbas said that it is the grain bug , or, according to another view; small locusts that do not have wings.15 ' Similar was reported from Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah and Qatadah. Al-Hasan and Said bin Jubayr said that ‘QummaF 111 Path Al-Bari 9 :535 and Muslim 3 : 1546 121 Musnad Ash-Sh&J72 :173, Ahmad 2 :97 and Ibn Mfijah 2 :1073. 131 At-Tabari 13:68. At-Tabari 13:54. 151 At-Tabari 13:54.

148 Tafsir Ibn Kathir are small black insects. Abu Jafar bin Jarir recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, “When Musa came to Fir‘awn, he demanded, ‘Release the Children of Israel to me.’ But, Fir'awn did not comply; and Allah sent the Tufan, and that is a rain which continued until they feared that it was a form of torment. They said to Musa, Invoke your Lord to release us from this rain, and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you.’ Musa invoked his Lord and He removed the affliction from them. However, they did not believe, nor did they send the Children of Israel with him. In that year, Allah allowed (the earth) to grow various types of produce, fruits and grass for them as never before. They said, This is what we hoped for.’ So Allah sent the locusts, and the locusts started to feed on the grass. When they saw the effect the locusts had on the grass, they knew that no vegetation would be saved from devastation. They said, ‘O Musa! Invoke your Lord so that He will remove the locusts from us, and we will believe in you and release the Children of Israel to you.’ Musa invoked his Lord, and He removed the locusts. Still, they did not believe and did not send the Children of Israel with him.

They collected grains and kept them in their homes. They said, 'We saved our crops.' However, Allah sent the Qummal, grain bugs, and one of them would take ten bags of grains to the mill, but only reap three small bags of grain. They said, 'O Musa! Ask your Lord to remove the Qummal (weevil) from us and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you.' Musa invoked his Lord, and Allah removed the Qummal from them. However, they did not send the Children of Israel with him. Once, when he was with Fir'awn, Musa heard the sound of a frog and said to Fir'awn, 'What will you and your people suffer from this (the frogs)?' Fir'awn said, 'What can frogs do?' Yet, by the time that night arrived a person would be sitting in a crowd of frogs that reached up to his chin and could not open his mouth to speak without a frog jumping in it. They said to Musa, 'Invoke your Lord to remove these frogs from us, and m At-Tabari 13:55.

149 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (132 - 135) (Part-9) we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you.' Musa invoked his Lord, but they did not believe. Allah then sent blood that filled the rivers, wells and the water containers they had. They complained to Fir'awn, saying, '*We are inflicted with blood and do not have anything to drink.' He said, 'Musa has bewitched you.' They said, 'How could he do that when whenever we look for water in our containers we found that it has turned into blood?' They came to Musa and said, 'Invoke your Lord to save us from this blood, and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you.' Musa invoked his Lord and the blood stopped, but they did not believe nor send the Children of Israel with him." A similar account was attributed to Ibn 'Abbas, As-Suddi, Qatadah and several others among the Salaf. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, "The enemy of Allah, Fir'awn, went back defeated and humiliated, after the sorcerers believed (in Musa). He insisted on remaining in disbelief and persisted in wickedness. Allah sent down the signs to him, and he (and his people) were first inflicted by famine. Allah then sent the flood, the locusts, the Qummal, the frogs then blood, as consecutive signs. When Allah sent the flood, it filled the surface of the earth with water. But the water level receded, and they could not make use of it to till the land or do anything else. They became hungry. This is when, id oqyJ jXf d* iixc. jl LL tlcj £5 iThey said : "O Musa! Invoke your Lord far us because of His promise to you . If you remove the punishment from us, we indeed shall believe in you, and we shall let the Children of Israel go with you.") Musa invoked his Lord and He removed the affliction from them, but they did not keep their promises. So Allah sent locusts that ate the trees and consumed the nails on their doors, until the doors fell from their homes and residences. They again said what they said to Musa before, and he called on his Lord and He removed the affliction. Still, they did not keep their promises, and Allah sent the

151 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (136 - 137) (Part-9 transgressed, even though He inflicted them with consecutive signs, one after another, He took retribution from them by drowning them in the sea that Musa parted by Allah's power, and he and the Children of Israel passed through. In their pursuit, Fir'awn and his soldiers went in the sea chasing MOsa and his people. When they all had gone inside the water, the sea closed in on them and they all drowned, because they belied the Ayat of Allah and were heedless of them. Allah said that He has granted the people who were considered weak, the Children of Israel, to inherit the eastern and western parts of the land. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah commented that Allah's statement, 4k&A# 6^} i...the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed.} refers to the Sham area (Greater Syria). Also, Mujahid and Ibn Jarir said that Allah's statement, iAnd the fair Word of your Lord was fulfilled far the Children of Israel, because of their

endurance.} is explained by Allah's other statement, JL S'^ tit's' >* i/ / / // ^ Atf . t H j J&j iAnd We wished to do a favor to those who were weak (and oppressed) in the land, and to make them rulers and to make them the inheritors. And to establish them in the land, and We let Fir'awn and Haman and their hosts receivefrom them that which theyfeared> (28:5-6). Further, Allah's statement, 4£j»j iAnd We destroyed what Fir'awn and his people produced,} meaning, We destroyed what Fir'awn and his people produced, such as agriculture and buildings.

J nv SB3P i)A JieZr-S^r^jy»-J CTi^j^3 ^C3!z43 v*_^1 l^!^!^===ujj1 J ||j J v^jll^iyITl; U6\$&y&»\$0 JLij3JJ v^SjJjojIzAiJOLI~*jiii &^£2U=£ gss&ax K \}&.C» iatid what they erected.} Ibn 'Abbas and Muja- hid said that itthey erected} means, they built. s# Js«£l fok ^J> jjc oy&i >y Je 'jilj \p !\$ jIA jtj %iii: ^ iX u J?£ l\ fpj& ?) pi i;r b j# « £ 6 32 4:\$^; ^238. And We brought the Children of Israel (with safety) across the sea, and they came upon a people devoted to some of their idols (in wor- ship). They said: "O Musa! Make for us a god as they have gods." He said: "Verily , you are an ignorant people."} 4239. [Musa added:] "Verily, these people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in (idols' worship). And all that they are doing is in vain."} The Children ofIsrael safely cross the Sea, but stillheld on to the Idea ofIdolWorshipping Allah mentions the words that the ignorant ones among the Children of Israel uttered to Musa after they crossed the sea and witnessed Allah's Ayat and great power. 4.1+1 iif&u ^y iyti^ iAnd they came upon a people devoted to some of their idols (in

153Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(138 - 139) (Part-9) worship). Some scholars of Tafsir said that the people mentioned here were from Canaan, or from the tribe of Lakhm. Ibn Jarir commented, "They were worshipping idols that they made in the shape of cows, and this influenced the Children of Israel later when they worshipped the calf. They said here. ppi jiiV. p, cr^ ti& i"0 Musa! Make for us a god as they have gods." He said: "Verily, you are an ignorant people.'V Musa replied, you Eire ignorant of Allah's greatness and majesty and His purity from any partners or anything resembling Him. i"Verily, these people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in} they will perish, cp} i"and all that they are doing is in vain."} Commenting on this Ayah, Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir reported from Abu Waqid Al-Laythi that they (the CompEmions) went out from Makkah with the Messenger of Allah sg for (the battle of) Hunayn. Abu Waqid SEiid, "Some of the disbelievers had a lote tree whose vicinity they used to remain in, and upon which they would hang their weapons on. That tree was called 'Dhat Al-Anwat. So when we passed by a huge, green lote tree, we said, 'O Messenger of Allah! Appoint for us a Dhat Al-Anwat as they have.' He said, • y fj* di* 5^ l_rrA' cS-jllJ by He in Whose Hand is my soul! You said just as zvhat the people ofMiisa said to him i; p pi ju t?;: 'fx lT up} *tM<xP isp i"Make for us a god as they have gods." He said: "Verily, !M At-Tabari 13:80.

155Sarah 7. Al-A'rdf(140 - 143) (Part-9) sent to them by speaking directly to Mdsa and revealing the Tawrah to him. In it, was their law and the details of their legislation. Allah stated here that He appointed thirty nights for Musa. The scholars of Tafsir said that Musa fasted this period, and when they ended, Musa cleaned his teeth with a twig. Allah commanded him to complete the term adding ten more days, making the total forty. When the appointed term finished, Musa was about to return to Mount fur, as Allah said, 40 Children of Israel! We delivered you from your enemy, and We made a covenant with you on the right side of the Mount (20:80]. Musa left his brother Harun with the Children of Israel and commanded him to use wisdom and refrain from mischief. This was only a reminder, for

Harun was an honorable and noble Prophet who had grace and exalted standard with Allah, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him and the rest of the Prophets. c0.!> alif t?X Jkit kl*j Jii fSj fl&j ivy;..) i^y &&&£a %jl\ 4 jt if® X Sfl , > 4143. And when Musa came at the time and place appointed by Us, and his Lord (Allah) spoke to him; he said: "O my Lord! Show me (Yourself), that I may look upon You." Allah said: "You cannot see Me, but look upon the mountain ; if it stands still in its place then you shall see Me." So when his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it collapse to dust, and Musa fell down unconscious. Then when he recovered his senses he said: "Glory be to You, I turn to You in repentance and I am the first of the believers Musa asks to see Allah Allah said that when Musa came for His appointment and spoke to Him directly, he asked to see Him,

156 Tafsir Ibn Kathir <T'0 my Lord! Show me (Yourself), that I may look upon You." Allah said: "You cannot see Me, "4 "You cannot' (Lan) by no means indicates that seeing Allah will never occur, as (the misguided sect of) Al-Mu'tazilah claimed. The Hadiths of Mutawatir grade * narrated from the Messenger of Allah, affirm that the believers will see Allah in the Hereafter. We will mention these Hadiths under the explanation of Allah's statement, 4Some faces that Day shall be radiant. Looking at their Lord.} (75:22-23] In earlier Scriptures, it was reported that Allah said to Musa, "O Musa! No living soul sees Me, but will perish, and no solid but will be demolished. "2 Allah said here, 4So when his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it collapse to dust, and Musa fell doivn unconscious .4 In his Musnad Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas bin Malik that the Prophet sg said about Allah's saying; 4And when his Lord appeared to the mountain, Like this then he held out the tip of his little finger.*3 * At- Tirmidhi recorded this in the chapter of Tafsir for this Ayah, then he said; "This Hadith is Hasan Sahih Ghanb." This was also recorded by Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak through the route of Hamad bin Salamah, and he said; "This Hadith is ?ahih according to the criteria of Muslim and they did not record it." * And As-Suddi reported that 'Ikrimah ** Having numerous narrators in each link of every chain. Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah 3:112. Ahmad 3:125. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :45 1 * Al-Hakim 2 :320

reported from Ibn 'Abbas about Allah's saying, 4&k&U 4And what his Lord appeared to the mountain, Only the extent of the little finger appeared from Him, 4He made it collapse^ as dust; try 4And Musa fell down unconscious fainting from it. Ibn Jarir recorded these because of the relation to the word Al-GhashL^ iTheti when he (Miisa) recovered his senses} after he lost consciousness, 4<J/i it} 4he said: "Glory be to You,"} thus, praising, glorifying and honoring Allah since no living soul could see Him in this life and remain alive. Musa' statement, idtil £} 4"I turn to You in repentance"} means, according to Mujahid, that from asking you to look at you, 4"and I am the first of the believers."}, among the Children of Israel, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, and Ibn Jarir preferred this view. Or, according to another narration from Ibn 'Abbas, the meaning of, K\$ U'j} 4"and I am the first of the believers."}, is that 'none shall see You (in this life).' Allah said, 1yy y~)} 4And Musa fell down unconscious.} m At-Tabari 13:97.

Abu Said Al-Khudri and Abu Hurayrah narrated a Hadlth from the Prophet that is suitable to mention here. As for the Hadith from Abu Sa'Id, Al-Bukhari recorded in his Sahih that he said: A Jew came to the Prophet jg after his face was smacked, and said, "O Muhammad! One of your companions from Al-Ansar smacked me on the face." The Prophet said, oSummon him» and he was summoned. The Prophet jg asked him, oWhy did you smack his face?* He said, "O Allah's Messenger! I passed by that Jew and

heard him swearing, 'No, by He Who has chosen Musa over mankind!' I said, 'Over Muhammad too?', and I became angry and struck his face." The Prophet said, 'Jrfi U* Jjl fji Oi oU *dVi 'll <Sjyr 'to bt ^ ^ "Do not prefer me above the Prophets. Verily, on the Day of Resurrection, people will be struck unconscious, and I (feel that I) am the first to wake up. Thereupon I will find that Musa is holding onto a pillar of the Throne ("Arsh of Allah). I will not know if he woke up before me or he received his due (because of

159 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (144 - 145) (Part-9 his) unconsciousness on (Mount) At-Tur. n' 1 ' Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in many locations of his Sahih, as did Muslim and Abu Dawud.*2 ' As for the Hadith from Abu Hurayrah, Imam Ahmad and the Two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) collected his narration.*3 ' 4'^\0i_-Ji j'j ^oyb. IjJu-t jLji 4244. (Allah) said: "0 Musa I have chosen you above men by My Messages, and by My speaking (to you). So hold that which I have given you and be of the grateful. 4245. And We wrote for him on the Tablets the exhortation all things and the explanation for all things (and said) : Hold unto these with firmness, and enjoin your people to take the better therein. 1 shall show you the home of the rebellious. Allah chooses Musa and gives Him the Tablets Allah states that He spoke to Musa directly and informed him that He has chosen him above the people of his time, by His Message and by speaking to him. Here we should mention that there is no doubt that Muhammad jg is the chief of all the Children of Adam, the earlier and later ones among them. This is why Allah has chosen him to be the Final and Last Prophet and Messenger, whose Law shall remain dominant and valid until the commencement of the Last Hour. Muhammad's followers are more numerous than the followers of all Prophets and Messengers. After Muhammad jg, the next in rank of honor and virtue is Ibrahim upon him be peace,, then MQsa, son of 'Imran, who spoke to the Most Beneficent directly. Allah commanded Musa, saying, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :152 121 Al-Bukhari, nos. 4638, 2412, 6917, 3398, 7427 and 6518, Muslim 2374 and Abu Dawud 4668 * Ahmad 2 :264 , Fath Al-Bari 13 :455 and Muslim 4 :1844

iSo hold to that which I have given you\$, of My Speech and conversation with you, iand be of the grateful^ , for it and do not ask for what is beyond your capacity to bear. Allah stated that He has written lessons and exhortation for all things and explanations for all things on the Tablets. It was said that in the Tablets, Allah wrote advice and the details of the commandments for lawful and prohibited matters. The Tablets contained the Tawrah, that Allah described; iAnd indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment for mankind}[28A3]. It was also said that Allah gave Musa the Tablets before the Tawrah, and Allah knows best. Allah said next, irk iHold unto these with firmness>, be firm on the obedience, bilt iand enjoin your people to take the better therein. Sufyan bin TJyaynah said, "Abu Sa'd narrated to us from Ikrimah from Ibn 'Abbas that "Musa, peace be upon him, was commanded to adhere to the toughest of what was ordained on his people." * Allah's statement, il shall sixmo you the home of the rebellious>, means, you will witness the recompense of those who defy My order and deviate from My obedience, the destruction, demise and utter loss they will suffer. V iji» J^==» 'JJIj jCu 4 o oli:\$ iK oij -juf 'i j\$ i;>: 14. ijL-S m At-Tabari 13:110.

ilylfj tbibli; [ylS" jib 4ti^fc ^ ji cJ^- <246. I shall him away from My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right, and (even) if they see all the Ayat, they will not believe in them. And if

they see the way of righteousness, they will not adopt it as the way, but if they see the way of error, they will adopt that way, that is because they have rejected Our Ayat and were heedless of them 4247. Those who deny Our Ayat and the meeting in the Hereafter, vain are their deeds. Are they requited with anything except what they used to do?} Arrogant People will be deprived of Allah's Ayat Allah said, 41 shall turn away from My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right}. Allah says, "I shall deprive the hearts of those who are too proud to obey Me, and arrogant with people without right, from understanding the signs and proofs that testify to My Might, Law and Commandments." And just as they acted arrogantly without justification, Allah has disgraced them with ignorance. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time} [6:110], and, ill d&} 4So when they turned away (from the path of Allah), Allah turned their hearts away (from the right path).} [61:5] Sufyan bin "Uyaynah commented on this Ayah, 44'J' <4 IA j>f2c}

41 shall turn away from My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right}, "(Allah says) I shall snatch away comprehension of the Qur'an from them and turn them away from My Ayat." * Ibn Jarir commented on Sufyan's statement that, "This indicates that this part of the Ayah is addressed to this Ummah." 121 This is not necessarily true, for Ibn TJaynah actually meant that this occurs in every Ummah and that there is no difference between one Ummah and another Ummah in this regard. Allah knows best. Allah said next, 4^ y *** !iit 4and (even) if they see all the Ayat, they will not believe in them}. Allah said in a similar Ayah, jX % 'i &j iTruly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) Allah's statement, 'i •'11 t ' 1: . 1'V 4And if they see the way of righteousness, they will not adopt it as the way,} means, even if the way of guidance and safety appears before them, they will not take it, but if the way that leads to destruction and misguidance appears to them, they adopt that way. Allah explains why they do this, Am 4that is because they have rejected Our Ayat}, in their hearts, 4and were heedless of them.}, gaining no lessons from the Ayat. Allah's statement, At-Tabari 13:112. 121 At-Tabari 13:113.

iThose who deny Our Ayat and the meeting in the Hereafter, vain are their deeds.} indicates that whoever among them does this, remaining on this path until death, then all his deeds will be in vain. Allah said next, i&tetW£ vi jl» iAre they requited with anything except what they used to do?} meaning, "We only recompense them according to the deeds that they performed, good for good and evil for evil. Surely, as you bring forth, you reap the harvest thereof.' Vj V\$ IjL1»- St iti Xjf-i)} -1* \5l)j lij 'A, rcfr. <<*3^3 »3 0% ^ ijiu <148. And the people of Musa made in his absence, out of their ornaments, the image of a calf (for worship). It had a sound. Did they not see that it could neither speak to them nor guide them to the way? They took it (for worship) and they were wrongdoers.} 4149. And when they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they said: "If our Lord have not mercy upon us and forgive us, we shall certainly be of the losers"} Story of worshipping the Calf Allah describes the misguidance of those who worshipped the calf that As-Samiri made for them from the ornaments they borrowed from the Copts. He made the shape of a calf with these ornaments and threw in it a handful of dust from the trace of the horse that the Angel Jibrfl was riding, and the calf seemed to moo. This occurred after Musa went for the appointed term with his Lord, where Allah told him about what happened when he was on Mount Tur. Allah said about His Honorable Self,

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 &\ r??Erz \$aptfftizV'p \fs^Z\£\hf?s\zT Cp^r-3 tJ" ?v pT^!. ^ mss vu ^ (6-m) (isi - osi)Mv-iv7mmS9l

167Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(150 - 151) (Part-9 you have not respected (waited or observed) my word!" }
 [20:92-94). Here, Allah said that Hariin said, Ms yflScJ \ jJ\$} i"0 son ofmy mother! Indeed the people
 judged me weak and were about to kill me, so make not the enemies rejoice over me, nor put me among
 the people who are wrongdoers." } Harun said, T)o not place me on the same level as they are, as if I
 was one of them.' Further, Harun said, 'O son of my mother', so that MQsa would feel more mercy and
 leniency towards him, even though Harun was also the son of Musa's father. When Musa was satisfied
 that his brother was innocent, I j ojj 'it yk Jb ot -&j} 4And Harun indeed had said to them beforehand:
 "O my people! You are being tried in this, and verily, your Lord is (Allah) the Most Gracious, so follow
 me and obey my order." } [20:90], this is when, iti} 4he said} Musa, 4"0 my Lord! Forgive me and my
 brother, and admit us into Your mercy, for you are the Most Merciful of those who show mercy." } Ibn
 Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, jJU ojJ>j \jZt jl Jpj 3* lj>.
 (Uo Lib Cl^l jii aMay Allah grant His mercy to Musa! Surely, he who observes [something] is nothing
 like he who is informed about it. His Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, told him that his people

168 Tafstr Ibn Kathir were tested after him, but he did not throw the Tablets. Wlten he saw them with
 his eyes, then he threw the TabletsV 4 (i+jj oi v-i* bi*' 4J' 6^ UjJo £>* ii&j Uj1(ijili 'jj> Lji>- "cjjjtj
 4252. Certainly, those who took the calf (for worship), wrath from their Lord and humiliation will come
 upon them in tire life of this world. Thus do We recompense those who invent lies.} il53. But those who
 committed evil deeds and then repented afterwards and believed, verily, your Lord after (all) that is
 indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The "wrath' mentioned here that struck the Children of Israel
 because of their worshipping the calf, means, Allah did not accept their repentance until some of them
 (who did not worship the calf) killed others [who worshipped the calf]. We mentioned this story in
 Surat Al-Baqarah, ji ft iep% -pti it %£) ii-S 4So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves
 (the guilty), that will be better for you before your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance. Truly,
 He is the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.} [2:54] As for the humiliation mentioned in
 the Ayah, it pertains to the disgrace and humiliation that the Jews suffered in the life of this world.
 Allah's statement, iThus do We recompense those who invent lies} is for all those who invent an
 innovation (in religion). Surely, the disgrace resulting from inventing an innovation (in religion) and
 defying Allah's Message, will be placed in the heart and from there on to the shoulders. Al-Hasan Al-
 Basri said; "The disgrace of innovation will weigh on their shoulders even if m Ibn Majah 2:380.

169 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (152 - 153) (Part-9) they were to gallop on their mules or trot on their work horses." Ayyub As-Sakhtiyani narrated from Abu Qilabah Al- Jarmi that he commented on this Ayah, {Thus do We recompense those who invent lies.} "By Allah! This Ayah is for all those who invent a lie, until the Day of Resurrection." * Also, Sufyan bin 'Uyaynah said, "Every person who invents a Bid'ah (innovation in the religion) will taste disgrace."*2 * Allah tells His servants that He accepts repentance from His servants for any sin, even Shirk, Kufr, hypocrisy and disobedience. Allah said: {And after that} after committing that evil action, {He is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Ibn Abi Hatim reported that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud was asked about a man committing fornication with a woman and then marrying her, and Ibn Mas'ud recited this Ayah, {But those who committed evil deeds and then repented afterwards and believed, verily, your Lord after (all) that is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 'Abdullah recited this Ayah ten times, neither allowing nor disallowing it. & A 4i \$ c!^* 321 4-3®^ At-Jabari 13:135. ' At-Tabari 13:136. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3:566.

And when the anger of Musa with his people, {if he took up the Tablets}, which he had thrown out of jealousy for Allah and anger for His sake, because of his people worshipping the calf, {his anger of Musa calmed, he took up the Tablets; and in their inscription was guidance and mercy for those who fear their Lord.} Musa picked up the Tablets when His Anger subsided Allah said next, {and in their inscription was guidance and mercy for those who fear their Lord.} Several scholars of Tafsir said that when Musa threw the Tablets on the ground they were shattered and he collected the pieces afterwards. Musa found in its inscription guidance and mercy, but the specific details of the Law was lost, so they said. They also claimed that the shattered pieces of the Tablets still remained in the treasury safes of some Israelite kings until the Islamic State came into existence. Only Allah knows if these statements are true.

171 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (155 - 156) (Part-9) {And Musa chose out of his people seventy (of the best) men for Our appointed time and place of meeting, and when they were seized with a violent earthquake, he said: "O my Lord, if it had been Your Will, You could have destroyed them and me before; would You destroy us for the deeds of the foolish among us? It is only Your trial by which You lead astray whom You will, and keep guided whom You will. You are our protector, so forgive us and have mercy on us : for You are the best of those who forgive us." And ordain for us good in this world, and in the Hereafter. Certainly we have Hudna unto You." He said: (As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those who have Taqwa, and give Zakah ; and those who believe in Our Ayat.} Seventy Men from the Children of Israel go for the appointed Meeting Place that Allah designated, Allah later on destroys them 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented; "Allah commanded Musa to choose seventy men. So he chose them and proceeded with them in order that they supplicate to their Lord. Their supplication included asking Allah, 'O Allah! Give us what you have never given anyone before us and will never give anyone after us!' Allah disliked this supplication and they were seized

with a violent earthquake, Musa said: *Ji* o; 5# i"0 my Lord, if it had been Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before.* At-Tabari 13:141.

As-Suddi said, "Allah commanded Musa to come with thirty men from the Children of Israel, apologizing for worshipping the calf; and He gave them an appointed time and place. iAnd Miisa chose out of his people seventy (of the best) men .} He chose these men and went along with them so that they could apologize. When they reached the appointed place, they said, 4We shall never believe in you}, [2:55] 'O Musa, 4'J-i* Jj iuntil we see Allah plainly,} for you spoke to Him,' they said, 'therefore, show Him to us,' ibut they were struck with a bolt of lightning [4:153] and they died. Musa stood up crying, invoking Allah, 'O Lord! What should I tell the Children of Israel, when I go back to them after You destroyed their best men?' 4"0 my Lord, if it had been Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "Musa chose seventy of the best men from the Children of Israel. He said to them, 'Go to the meeting with Allah and repent for what you committed. Beg His forgiveness for those of your people whom you left behind. Fast, purify yourselves and clean your clothes.' So, he went with them to Mount Tur in Sinai for the meeting place and time designated by his Lord. He went there only with the leave and knowledge of Allah. According to what has been mentioned to me, when the seventy did what he ordered them to do, and went with him to the meeting of Musa with his Lord, they said, 'Request that we may also hear the words of m At-Tabari 13:140.

173 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (155 - 156) (Part-9)_ our Lord.' So he replied, 1 shall.' When Musa approached the mountain it became completely covered with columns of clouds, Musa approached it and entered in them. He said to the people, 'Approach.' But when Allah spoke to Musa, his cloak was surrounded by a brilliant light which no human could bear to look at, so below him a barrier was placed and the people approached. When they entered the cloud they fell prostrate and they heard Him while he was speaking to Musa, commanding him and forbidding him, saying what to do and what not to do. When He completed commanding him, and removed the cloud from Musa, he faced the people and they said, 'O Musa! We will not believe in you unless we see Allah directly.' So the thunder shook them, their souls were captured and they all died. Musa stood up invoking, begging and supplicating to his Lord, i"0 my Lord, if it had beat Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before.'V 1 ' meaning, They were foolish. Would You destroy anyone who comes after me from the Children of Israel?' Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, Mujahid and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari said, "They were seized by the tremor or lightning, because they neither shunned nor forbade their people who worshipped the calf."121 This is supported by Musa's statement, 4'would You destroy us for the deeds of the fools among hs?'"\$ He said next, yj, j i"lt is only Your Fitnah affliction, test and trial, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas and several among the Salaf and latter scholars. 13 ' This is the only plausible meaning, in which Musa says, "The decision is Yours (O Allah), and the judgment, and whatever You will 111 At-Tabari 13:140. 121 At-Tabari 13:143-144. ,31 At-Tabari 13:151.

occurs. You misguide whom You will, guide whom You will, and none can guide whom You misguide or misguide whom You guide. There is none who can give what You deprive or avert what You give. The sovereignty is all Yours, and Yours is the judgment, the creation and the decision."The Ayah, 4"You are our protector, so forgive us and have mercy on us: for You are the best of those who forgive.'y, pertains to (Allah s) covering the mistake and not punishing for the sin. Whenever mercy is mentioned along

with forgiveness [such as in Musa's supplication to Allah], it includes the hope that Allah does not permit one to fall into that act again. i'for You are the best of those who forgive/> for none except You can forgive the sin. UjIi .jci j VJ i" And ordain for us good in this world, and in the Hereafter.'y The first part of Musa's supplication was to fend off what should be avoided, while this part is a request for what is sought. The meaning of, C& 4 Q i" And ordain for us good in this world, and in the Hereafter '> is, 'ordain for us and grant us all that is good in both lives. We mentioned the meaning of 'good' before in Surat Al- Baqarahft i" We have Hudna unto You'y "we repent, go back and return unto You,' according to the meaning of, 'Hudna.', given by Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Ad-Dahhak, Ibrahim At-Taymi, As-Suddi, Qatadah and several others.*2 *** See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah [2 : 200-202]. At-Tabari 13:154-155.

175 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (155 - 156) (Part-9) 'i i oy^i uM>J, J 4. r 4 He said : (As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those who have Taqwa, and give Zakah ; and those who believe in Our Aycity (7:156) Allah's Mercy is for Those Who have Taqwa and believe in Allah's Ayat and His Messenger sgj Allah answers the statement, i&k% ji i" It is only Your trial..." } (7:155), by saying, 4(As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things.} Allah says here, 1 do what I will, decide what I will and I have wisdom and justice in all matters.' Certainly, there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. Allah's statement, iand My mercy embraces all things testifies to His encompassing mercy. Allah said that the angels who carry His Throne and those around the Throne supplicate, 4" Our Lord! You comprehend all things in mercy and knowledge." } (40:7) Imam Ahmad recorded that Jundub bin 'Abdullah Al-Bajali said, "A bedouin man came, he made his camel kneel and he tied it. Then he prayed behind the Messenger of Allah sfe. When the Messenger of Allah sg finished the prayer, that man untied his camel mounted it and supplicated aloud, 'O Allah! Grant Your mercy to me and to Muhammad, and do not give a share in it to anyone else.' The Messenger of Allah

commented (to his Companions), U I pi^ jf Jj,{ lii «Do yoM think that this man is more misguided or his camel? Did you not hear what this man has said? They said, "Yes.' He ag said, ZJ-j Jyti ZJ-j iib jL4 j <iil jl UL-lj i4>-j o^k>- AiJi jii li-IJ Ljjjjj 14L. jiiijl "You (the bedouin man) have restricted a vast mercyl Allah, the Exalted, the most Honored has created a hundred mercies and sent down one of them by which the creation, men, Jinn and animals, show mercy to each other. He left with Him ninety-nine mercies, so do you say that this man is more misguided or his camel? Ahmad111 and Abu Dawud collected this Hadith, > Imam Ahmad recorded that Salman narrated that the Prophet said, 146 jkji tft <j-'j >44* j*»-5 y ji» j\ JjjZS) iZZ 'y-^j liaVjf^ *Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, has a hundred mercies. With one of them, the creations show mercy to each other, and even the beasts show kindness to their offspring. He has kept ninety-nine mercies with Him for the Day of Resurrection »131 Muslim recorded it.14 ' Allah said next, Uk iThat (mercy) I shall ordain for those who have Taqwa meaning, I will ordain My mercy for them, as a favor and kindness from Me to them. Allah said in a similar Ayah, *** Ahmad 4 :312. 121 Abu Dawud 5:197. 131 Ahmad 5 :439 Muslim 4 :2108.

iki# *_j;£p; iHe has prescribed mercy far Himself a [6:12] Allah's statement, ifar those who have Taqwa}, means, 1 will ordain My mercy for those who possess these qualities, and they are the Ummah of Muhammad,' Ukt ifar those wlv have Taqwifa, who avoid Shirk and major sins. iand give the

Zakah}, purify themselves, according to one opinion. It was also said that, *the Zakah', here pertains to wealth. It is possible that both meanings are included here, for this Ayah was revealed in Makkah [before Zakah in fixed shares was ordained], and those who believe in Our Aydt.}, those who have faith in them. j (Uie&& iS/s* is# IS & U/j jS=uli(f -CLtk £-&>j \$ ts ;iif il57. Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom they find written of with them in the Tawrah and the Injil, - he commands them to do good; and forbids them from evil; he makes lawful for them the good things, and forbids them from the evil things, he releases them from their heavy burdens and from the fetters that were upon them. So those who believe in him, honor him, help him, and follow the light which has been sent down with him, it is they who will be successful.}

The Description of that Messenger^ 4 ^}H\ oydi hjfy iThose who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom they find written with them in the Tawrah and the Injil This is the description of the Prophet Muhammad in the Books of the Prophets. They delivered the good news of his advent to their nations and commanded them to follow him. His descriptions were still apparent in their Books, as the rabbis and the priests well know. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Sakhr Al-'Uqayli said that a bedouin man said to him, "I brought a milk-producing camel to Al-Madlnah during the life time of Allah's Messenger. After I sold it, I said to myself, I will meet that man (Muhammad) and hear from him.' So I passed by him while he was walking between Abu Bakr and TJmar, and I followed them until they went by a Jewish man, who was reading from an open copy of the Tawrah. He was mourning a son of his who was dying and who was one of the most handsome boys. The Messenger of Allah jg asked him (the father), IJia ^ jl>J JJ* o}j*pi\ J^il «J ask you by He Wlto has sent down the Tawrah, do you not find the description of me and my advent in your Book?» He nodded his head in the negative. His son said, "Rather, yes, by He Who has sent down the Tawrah! We find the description of you and your advent in our Book. I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that you are the Messenger of Allah.' The Prophet sg said (to the Companions), «Stop the Jew (the father) from (taking care of) your brother (in Islam) .» The Prophet then personally took care of the son's funeral and led the funeral prayer on him.'" This Hadith is sound and is supported by a similar Hadith in the Sahih narrated *** Ahmad 5:411

179 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (57) (Part-9) from Anas. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Muthanna said that 'Ata' bin Yasar said, "I met 'Abdullah bin 'Amr and asked him, Tell me about the description of Allah's Messenger jg in the Tawrah.' He said, Yes, by Allah! He is described in the Tawrah, just as he is described in the Qur'an, 40 Prophet! Verily, We have sent you as a witness, and a bearer of glad tidings, and a warner. [33:45] as a safe refuge for the unlettered ones. You are My servant and Messenger. I have called you 'Al-Mutawakkil' (who trusts in Allah), not hard or harsh.' Neither uttering foul speech in the markets nor returning evil deed with one in kind. Rather, he forgives and forgoes. Allah will not end his life until He straightens through him the crooked religion, so that they might proclaim, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah.' He will open through him sealed hearts, deaf ears and blind eyes.'" 'Ata' then said, "I also met Ka*b and asked him the same question, and his answer did not differ from 'Abdullah's answer, even concerning one letter.",2) Al-Bukhari recorded it ' from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr. It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari [up to the word] forgoes. And he mentioned the narration of 'Abdullah bin 'Amr then he said; "It was common in the speech of our Salaf that they describe the Books of the People of the Two Scriptures as the Tawrah, as some HadUhs concur. Allah knows best."

Allah's statement, 4He commands them to do good; andforbids themfrom evil; } This is the description of the Messenger of Allah sg in previous Books. These were the true qualities of our Messenger jg, as well, for he only ordained good and forbade evil. We should mention here that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "When you hear Allah's statement, 111 Fath Al-B&ri3 :259 At-Jabari 13:164. 131 Fath Al-Bari4 : 402

4 04^ 40 you who believe!}, then pay it your full attention, for it is a good that you are being commanded, or an evil that you are being forbidden." And the most important and greatest of these commands and prohibitions, is that Allah has sent the Messenger j§ to order worshipping Him Alone without partners and forbid worshipping others besides Him. This is the Message that Allah has sent all Messengers with before Muhammad m, just as Allah said, JV >•5 si ji- 4And verily, We have sent among every Utntnah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allalt, and avoid the Tdghut (false deities)">[16:36]. Allah's statement, 4He makes lawful for them the good things, and forbids them from the evil things,} meaning, he makes the Bahlrah, Sa'ibah, Wasllah and Ham, etc., lawful. They were prohibitions that they invented which were only hard for themselves. He also forbids them from evil things, such as the flesh of the pig, Riba, and foods that were treated as lawful although Allah the Exalted had forbidden them. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported this from Ibn 'Abbas. Allah's statement, 4^&\$ 4He (Muhammad) releases them from their heavy burdetis, and from thefetters that were upon them.} indicates that Muhammad came with leniency and an easy religion. As mentioned in the Hadith recorded from many routes that Allah's Messenger^ said. 0/ was sent with the easy way ofHanifiyyah [monotheismJ» 111 At-Jabari 13:166. Ahmad 5:266 and 6:116.

The Prophet jg said to the two Commanders he appointed, Mu'adh and Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, when he sent them to Yemen, Yj u;ik-j Yj IaJ Yj 1 Yj iBring glad tidings and do not drive people away, make things easy and do not make them difficult, obey each other and do not differ among yourselves». 111 Abu Barzah Al-Aslami, the Prophet's Companion, said, "I accompanied the Messenger of Allah and saw how easy he was. The nations that were before us had things made difficult for them in their laws. Allah made the law encompassing and easy for this Ummah. Hence the statement of the Messenger of Allah, jt j*J U U 1 . <j U jjt»«j iul jU aAllah has forgiven my Ummah for what occurs in themselves, as long as they do not utter it or act upon

The Prophet jg said, ijk u; ielJi; (yji jS ifo «My Ummah was forgiven (by Allah) unintentional errors, forgetfulness and what they areforced to do.»*31 This is why Allah has guided this Ummah to proclaim, je Lj* j-ia 'Ij j Ua_-> oj, y & tesc Q jufj & rA g istt y u y; e; uj i"Our Lord! Punish us not ifwe forget or fall into error, our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (Jews and Christians); our Lord! Put not on us a burden greater than we have strength to bear. Pardon us and grant us forgiveness. Have mercy on us. You are our Mawla (Patron, Supporter and Protector) and give us victory over the 1,1 Fath Al-Bari 5 :188 121 Fath Al-Bdn 9:300. 131 Ibn Majah 1 :659

41 am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah,} This Ayah mentions the Prophet's honor and greatness, for he is the Final Prophet who was sent to all mankind [and the Jinns]. Allah said, 4'£ '<yj (5j '•£» 3[jrj'j ^ fj rr - *** 4*^ 4Say, "Allah is Witness between you and 1; this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach."} [6:19], 4but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place}[11:17], and, ijiL-t oji yi'S'Ja cwi1

4And say to those who were given the Scripture and to the illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do you (also) submit yourselves (to Allah in Islam)?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message.} [3:20] There are many other Ayat and more Hadiths than can be counted on this subject. It is also well-known in our religion that the Messenger of Allah jg was sent to all mankind [and the Jinns]. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Ad-Darda' said, "Abu Bakr and Umar had an argument in which Abu Bakr made Umar angry. So Umar went away while angry and Abu Bakr followed him asking him to forgive him, but Umar refused. Umar shut his door closed in Abu Bakr's face and Abu Bakr went to the Messenger of Allah while we were with him. The Messenger of Allah said, Jwi IjLa jLisU-Li uThisfellow ofyours (Abu Bakr) has made someone angryfr Umar became sorry for what he did, went to the Prophet s^5 and greeted him with the Salam and sat next to him, telling

185Surah 7 . Al-A'raf(158 - 159) (Part-9) gives life and causes death.} describes Allah by the words of the Messenger jg that He Who has sent him is the Creator, Lord and King of all things and in His Hand is the control, life, death and the decision. Just as Allah said feVf aJ-jiA iSo believe in Allah and His Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write,} Allah proclaims here that Muhammad jg is His Messenger and reiterates this fact by commanding that he be believed in and followed. Allah said, ^} iThe Prophet zvho can neither read nor write} who you were promised and given the good news of in previous revealed books. Certainly, Muhammad was amply described in the previous books, including his description as being the unlettered Prophet. Allah's statement, iwho believes in Allah and His Words}, means, his actions conform with his words and he believes in what he was given from his Lord. iAndfollow him}, embrace his path and guidance, iso that you may be guided} to the Straight Path. 'ftJ cA & 2ry jiA 4259 . And of the people of Musa there is a community who lead (the men) with truth and establish justice therewith.} Allah stated that of the Children of Israel there are some who follow the truth and judge by it, just as He said in another Ayah,

People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah. They do not sell the verses ofAllah for a small price, for them is a reward with their Lord. Surely, Allah is Swift in account.} [3:199] jilt lix ijlli '^c- liji 'yflofS. 'ti f* Oi */>S i&>j< ^ tip oj iTfwse to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truthfrom our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from those who submit themselves. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient.}[28:52-54], and,

jliiSi C>££ ij-^t 'jj. «Jj j; |>J CfJ 4 "•\$£>—» lyf^yU.J £> •**> 6^ iVerily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it (this Qur'an) is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise ofour Lord must be fulfilled." And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.}[7:107-109] L£IX >1 zfy& bl ^ Gili; '££2 o?Gl^ ii. £5 o. ajJUS £3 p# qsfe ^ Scg8f sii^ # Ji Hj c&j •Mii J&j :4 4,d» LIL* tj& jj £ Sg £4 ^ ^160. And We divided them into twelve tribes (as distinct) nations. We revealed to Musa when his people asked him for water (saying): "Strike the stone with your stick," and there gushed forth out of it twelve springs, each group knew its own placefor water. We shaded them with the clouds and sent down upon them the manna and the quail (saying) : "Eat of the good things with which We have provided you." They harmed Us not but they used to harm themselves. 4161. And (remember) when it

was said to them : "Dwell in this toion (Jerusalem) and eat therefrom wherever you wish, and say, '(O Allah) forgive our sins'; and enter the gate prostrating (bowing with humility). We shall forgive you your wrongdoings. We shall increase (the reward) for the good- doers . " } 4162. But those among them who did wrong, changed the word that had been told to them. So We sent on them a tormentfrom the heaven in return for their wrongdoings.}

We discussed these Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah which was revealed in Al-Madlnah, while these Ayat were revealed in Makkah. We also mentioned the difference between the two narrations, and thus we do not need to repeat it here, all thanks are due to Allah and all the favors are from Him. H vlil' 4 O'?*- if p } > f. JW * I / « .f /• fJt IL> 4163. And ask them about the town that was by the sea; when they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath : when their fish came to them openly on the Sabbath day, and did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath . Thus We made a trialfor them, for they used to rebel against Allah's command. The Jews transgress the Sanctity ofthe Sabbath This Ayah explains Allah's statement, 4^1*.-!' 4 ojj' JiLlt 4And indeed you knew those among you who transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath..} {2:65] Allah says to His Prophet sg here. 4And ask them} ask the Jews who are with you, about the story of their fellow Jews who defied Allah's command, so that His punishment overtook them all of a sudden for their evil actions, transgression and defiance by way of deceit. Also, warn the Jews (O Muhammad) against hiding your description that they find in their books, so that they do not suffer what their forefathers suffered. The village mentioned here is Aylah, on the shore of the Qulzum (Red) Sea. Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded from Ddwud bin Al-Husayn from Ikrimah that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, if (*4^*3} 4And ask them about the town that was by the sea...} I 1 See the Tafsir of SuratAl-Baqarah [2 :60)

“A village called Aylah between Madyan and At-Tur (which is in Sinai). 111 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi said similarly.12 ' Allah's statement, iwhett they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath;} means, they transgressed in the Sabbath and defied Allah's command to them to keep it sanctified, « }y. iwhen theirfish came to them openly on the Sabbath day,} visible on top of the water, according to Ad-Dahhak who reported it from Ibn 'Abbas.'3 ' Ibn Jarir said, “Allah's statement, .41' ie —> . V iand did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath. Thus We made a trial ofthem,} means, this is how We tested them by making the fish swim close to the surface of the water , on the day which they were prohibited to fish. The fish would be hidden from them on the day when they were allowed to fish, ii)&£=*} iThus We made a trialfor them,} so thatWe test them. i&Z \J£ £,} ifor they used to rebel against Allah's command} by defying His obedience and rebelling against it.” [4) Therefore, these were a people who used a trick to violate Allah's prohibitions, taking an action that seemed legal on the surface. However, in reality, this action was meant to transgress the prohibition. Imam and scholar Abu 'Abdullah Ibn Battah reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah \$5 said, I 11 At-Tabari 13:180. ' At-Tabari 13:180-181. 131 At-Tabari 13:183. '41 At-Tabari 13:183.

Mm* wr asaip ^ o (4|vrt^Si>j |v|l| < V".« ->i< i-";c tf 3^Z*£>-o}jiAyp^iU#Ai^l^U^ctj^uu^ ' / ':f " < . . '!' "s;\ '£'s' '\.:x O4 '^sj-; i>*~!<9%>'>J'J OJJ(nHJ #;<' • "f fT""T<£*i -> *'m>\" \. \'.<.\' —a.l^-,>a , , Uo 0>*»y;f*-fruu v_)U.t..~l >_> - >.>" ' ^"" c VI" " ^TK "t ' ' <> ^>V» * * fr S' m \y .s iAS^S Ijii i oJ5ji U l^s5> v» 4)1 ^jL>«-4 ljJL>tLlj g*j| «Do not repeat what the Jews committed, and violate Allah's

prohibitions using deceitful tricks This Hadith has a reasonable chain. & p £i iil &} 0£^ ji ^ sjoJ^ ijllj IbjS c ys c\$ ivuiSjii; 4% ^ b& Cii ^(&4 !j& <yi k£1j ^ ^ \y^ llj j-Cj ^jiJUi if wf*V* > !ir ^ <i* \jr*^ t# p. us is 4 ""ii' '1 4264. Aw/ when a community among them said: "Why do you preach to a people whom AllOh is about to destroy or to punish ivith a severe torment?" (The preachers) said: "In order to be free from guilt before your Lord (Allah), and perhaps they may fear Allah."} 4265. So when they forgot the reminder that had been given to them, We rescued those who forbade evil, but with a severe torment We seized those who did wrong, because they used to rebel against Allah's command.} 4166. So when they exceeded the limits of what they were prohibited, We said to them: "Be you monkeys, despised."} * J * Adab Az-Zafafp. 192.

191Surah 7. Al-A'raf (164 - 166) (Part-9) Those Who breached the Sabbath were turned into Monkeys, but Those Who prohibited Their Actions were saved Allah said that the people of this village were divided into three groups, a group that committed the prohibition, catching fish on the Sabbath, as we described in the Tafsir of Surat Al- Baqarah.' 1| Another group prohibited them from transgression and avoided them. A third group neither prohibited them, nor participated in their action. The third group said to the preachers, 4"Why do you preach to a people whom Allah is about to destroy or to punish with a severe torment?"}. They said, "why do you forbid these people from evil, when you know that they are destroyed and have earned Allah's punishment?' Therefore, they said, there is no benefit in forbidding them. The preachers replied, 4# ell i"In order to befreefrom guilt before your Lord (Allah),"} "forwe were commanded to enjoin righteousness and forbid evil,' i "and perhaps they may fear Allah"} for on account of our advice, they might stop this evil and repent to Allah. Certainly, if they repent to Allah, Allah will accept their repentance and grant them His mercy.' Allah said, }So when they forgot the reminder that had been given to them,} when the evil doers refused the advice, i\& G® £i£ £%} iWe rescued those who forbade evil, but We seized who did wrong,} l 1 * See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah [2 :65-66)

192 Tafsfr lbn Kathir who committed the transgression, iwith a severe torment). Allah stated that those who enjoined good were saved, while those who committed the transgression were destroyed, but He did not mention the end of those who were passive (the third group), for the compensation is comparable to the deed. This type did not do what would warrant praise, nor commit wrong so that they are admonished. 'Ikrimah said, "lbn 'Abbas said about the Ayah: 1 do not know whether or not the people were saved who said; i ia by jJU 4"Why do you preach to a people whom Allah is about to destroy...?") So I continued discussing it with him until I convinced him that they were. Then he gave me [the gift of] a garment."111 Allah said, iand We seized those who did wrong with a Ba'fs torment) indicating that those who remained were saved. As for 'Bats', it means 'severe', according to Mujahid, 121 or 'painful', according to Qatadah.131 These meanings are synonymous, and Allah knows best. Allah said next, 4fr^l) idespised), humiliated, disgraced and rejected. ? I 1 > -> > *' 4167. And (remember) when your lord declared that He would certainly keep on sending against them, till the Day of Resurrection, those who would afflict them with a humiliating At-Tabari 13:187. At-Tabari 13:202. At-Tabari 13:202.

193Surah 7. Al-A'rdf(164 - 167) (Part-9) torment. Verily, your Lord is quick in retribution and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Eternal Humiliation placed on the Jews 4Ta'dhdhana} means

‘declared’, according to Mujahid, or ‘ordained’, according to others. This part of the Ayah indicates a vow, 4that He will keep on sending against them} against the Jews, 4till the Day of Resurrection, those who would afflict them with a humiliating torment.} on account of their disobedience, defying Allah’s orders and Law and using tricks to transgress the prohibitions. It was reported that Musa required the Jews to pay the production tax for seven or thirteen years, and he was the first to do so. Also, the Jews fell under the humiliating rule of the Greek Kushdanln , 1 ’ 1 Chaldeans and later on the Christians, who subjugated and disgraced them, and required them to pay the Jizyah (tribute tax). When Islam came and Muhammad was sent, they became under his power and had to pay the Jizyah, as well. Therefore, the humiliating torment mentioned here includes disgrace and paying the Jizyah, as Al-‘Awfi narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas . 121 In the future, the Jews will support the Dajjal (False Messiah); and the Muslims, along with Isa, son of Mary, will kill the Jews. This will occur just before the end of this world. Allah said next, 4Verily, your Lord is quick in retribution}, with those who disobey Him and defy His Law, 4JU: 3A2 %~} 111 Perhaps it refers to the Kushite Dynasty, and Allah knows best. 121 At-Tabari 13:205.

and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) for those who repent and go back to Him. This Ayah mentions both the mercy, as well as, the punishment, so that no despair is felt. Allah often mentions encouragement and warning together, so that hearts always have a sense of hope and fear. 1 JS5 *Ut& 3? ftji i'flkok ofjf \$31 OjiL !£ »>^ff JtiifJ !_ • C jij” <265. And We have broken them (the Jezos) up into various separate groups on the earth : some of them are righteous and some are away from that. And We tried them with good (blessings) and evil (calamities) in order that they might turn (to Allah.) il69. Then after them succeeded an (evil) generation, which inherited the Book, but they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life saying: "(Everything) will be forgiven to us." And if (agabi) the offer of the like (evil pleasures of this world) came their way, they would (again) seize them (would commit those sins). Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth? And they have studied what is in it (the Book). And the home in the Hereafter is better for those who have Taqioa. Do not you then understand?) 4170. And as to those who hold fast to the Book (act on its teachings) and perform the Salah, certainly We shall never waste the reward of those who do righteous deeds.) The Children of Israel scatter throughout the Land Allah states that He divided the Jews into various nations, sects and groups, jiytf Si &>) 4And We said to the Children of Israel after him (after Musa

195Surah 7. Al-A'raf (168 - 170) (Part-9) died): "Divell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as a tnixed crowd (gathered out ofvarious nations) ."}[17:104] 4sowe o/ them are righteous and some are awayfrom that}, some of them are led aright and some are not righteous, just as the Jinns declared, 4 !>0^-4 OJi it* \$j} 4“There are among us some that are righteous, and some the contrary; we are groups having different ways (religious sects).”} [72:1 1] Allah said here, iAnd We tried them}, and tested them, iwith good and evil}, with times of ease, difficulty, eagerness, fear, well-being and affliction, 4in order that they might turn (to Allah)} Allah said next, 'ji d*i/- yf} wiii- OJ iThen after them succeeded an (evil) generation, which inherited the Book, but they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life} This Ayah means, after the generation made up of righteous and unrighteous people, another generation came that did not have goodness in them, and they inherited the Tawrah and studied it. Mujahid commented on Allah’s

statement, {They chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life} “They will consume anything they can consume in this life, whether legally or illegally. Yet, they wish for forgiveness,

196 Tafstr Ibn Kathir t fi-t ij>j- oiy U oyyyr iSaying: "(Everything,) will be forgiven for us."And if (again) the offer of the like came their way, they would (again) seize them.y*1] Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, ia'h'i Jv- 'oy£Xf “they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life» “This, by Allah, is an evil generation, <^& %> iwhich inherited the Booty after their Prophets and Messengers, for they were entrusted with this job by Allah's command to them. Allah said in another Ayah, iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who neglect the Salah (the prayers) .} [19:59] Allah said next, 1 " / >•>// oyyb) oj-ii-Uy iThey chose the goods of this low life saying: "(Everything) will be forgiven to us."} They wish and hope from Allah, while deceiving themselves, iAnd if (again) the offer of the like came their way, they would (again) seize them.} Nothing stops them from this behavior, for whenever they are given an opportunity in this life, they will consume regardless of it being allowed or not.” |2! As-Suddi said about Allah's statement, iThen after them succeeded an (evil) generation} until. m At-Tabari 13:212. At-Tabari 13:213.

197Surah 7. Al-A'raf (168 - 170) (Part-9) 4and they have studied what is in it (the Book).} “Every time the Children of Israel appointed a judge, he used to take bribes. The best ones among them held a counsel and took covenants from each that they would not take bribes. However, when one of them would take bribes in return for judgment and was asked, “What is the matter with you; you take a bribe to grant judgment?”, he replied, 1 will be forgiven. So the rest of his people would admonish him for what he did. But when he died, or was replaced, the one who replaced him would take bribes too. Therefore, Allah says, if the others (who admonished him) would have a chance to loot this world, they will take it.” * Allah said, i&\ ^U£ \)X * ££ \$} 4Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth?} thus, admonishing them for this behavior. Allah took a pledge from them that they would declare the truth to people and not hide it. Allah said in another Ayah, ifSe, y; oM 'yj* jM & & '>& i(And remember) when Allah took a covenant from those who were given the Scripture to make it known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threw it away behind their backs, and purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed worst is that which they bought} (3:187). Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn ‘Abbas said about the Ayah, yjU£ 'J cJ U. \$} 4Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth?}, “Their claim that Allah will forgive the sins they keep committing without repenting from them.” ' Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 13:213. * At-Tabari 13:215.

^Li' i jOj iAnd the home in the Hereafter is better for those who have Taqwd Do not you then understand?} Encouraging them to seek Allah's tremendous reward and warning them against His severe torment. Allah says here, “My reward and what I have are better for those who avoid prohibitions, abandon lusts and become active in the obedience of their Lord.’ iDo not you then understand?} Allah says’ Do not these people, who preferred this life instead ofwhat is with Me, have any sense to prohibit them from their foolish and extravagant ways?’ Allah then praises those who adhere to His Book, which directs them to follow His Messenger Muhammad jg, iAnd as to those who holdfast to the Book} adhere to it, implement its commands and refrain from its prohibitions, }and

perform the Saldh, certainly We shall never waste the reward of those who do righteous deeds.} ^ tiam&i wr ^ -**' <iU'S ^ ly jL.ajlj.fe&lsj 1 yiff

199Surah 7. Al-A‘rdf (171) (Part-9) ip il71. And (remember) when We hlataqna the mountain over them as if it had been a canopy, and they thought that it was going to fall on them (We said) : "Hold firmly to what We have given you [the Tawrdh], and remember that which is therein (act on its commandments) , so that you may fear Allah and obey Him."} Raising Mount Tur over the Jews, because of Their Rebellion ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, iAnd (remember) when We Nataqna the tmountain over them}, “We raised the mountain, as Allah’s other statement testifies, iAnd for their covenant, We raised over them the mountain} (4:154).” 111 Also, Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that Al-A‘mash said that. Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The angels raised the Mount over their heads, as reiterated by Allah’s statement, i’jA iWe raised over them the mountain} (4:154).” Al-Qasim bin Abi Ayyub narrated that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “MQsa later on proceeded with them to the Sacred Land. He took along the Tablets, after his anger subsided, and commanded them to adhere to the orders that Allah ordained to be delivered to them. But these orders became heavy on them and they did not want to implement them until Allah raised the mountain over them, 111 At-Tabari 13:218.

20® — Tafsir Ibtt Kathir ias if it had been a canopy}, that is, when the angels raised the mountain over their heads.” An-Nasa’i collected it.' \$^ Ji Jtfj ii-1 ijj^ o; GjCI. 4^ It} jl ipcsiii lii IjI gijiT ljj^ fr; f®> && \${{&£ j3 ^ i&£3 J^s ^ ££ 35 <272. And (remember) when your Lord brought forth from the Children ofAdam, from their loins, their seed and made them testify as to themselves (saying) : "Am I not your Lord?" They said: "Yes! We testify," lest you should say on the Day of Resurrection : "Verily, we were unaware of this."} 4173. Or lest you should say: "It was only our fathers aforetime who took others as partners in worship along with Allah, and we were (merely their) descendants after them; will You then destroy us because of the deeds ofmen who practiced falsehood?"} 4174. Thus do We explain the Ayat in detail, so that they may turn (unto the truth) .} The Covenant taken from the Descendants ofAdam Allah stated that He brought the descendants ofAdam out of their fathers loins, and they testified against themselves that Allah is their Lord and King and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. Allah created them on this Fitrah, or way, just as He said, Jii IL->- jyyB Jjfe) 4So set you (O Mulmmmad) your face truly towards the religion, Hanifan. Allah's Fitrah with which He has created mankind. No change let there be in Khalqillah. > [30:30] And it is recorded in the Two Sahihs from Abu Hurayrah who said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said, An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubra : 6:396. [01

The meaning of this Ayah is, "Dedicate yourself to the natural

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2071–2120]

religion ofAllah which He made for humanity."

jyy <jlj>si-u oljjli iOjiaAJl jJjj J|5 * ^Lp«i>- 1^6 j^w>J • l_ *_*kJ>- «Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, it is only his parents who turn him into a Jew, a Christian or a Zoroastrian. Just as animals are bom having full bodies, do you see any of them having a cutoffnose (when they are bom)*. [11 Muslim recorded that ‘Iyad bin ‘Himar said that the Messenger of Allah sg said; 'pf-ii j* »Ul>- tJiCe ciU :Jjll

JjZj vAlIdh said, 7 created My servants Hunafa' (monotheists), but the devils came to them and deviated them from their religion, prohibiting what I allowed.^ There are Hadiths that mention that Allah took Adam's offspring from his loins and divided them into those on the right and those on the left. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Prophet jg said, 5^1 vtU jIS)} cjtjf iiUiJl (ym jtlil jif Zjt ii illJi ja jy*\ dll* >L}j\ ji : :JjZj :JU <, EjuLil is\jEsM 7 1 lid^ iJjii 7 M fii^j id «/f will be said to a man from the people of the Fire on the Day of Resurrection, 'If you owned all that is on the earth, would you pay it as ransom?' He will reply, 'Yes.' Allah will say, 7 ordered you with what is less than that, when you were still in Adam's loins, that is, associate none with Me (in worship). You insisted that you associate with Me (in worship).' »*31 This was recorded in the Two Sahihs*4) Commenting on this Ayah (7:172), At-Tirmidhi recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, Fath Al-Bari3 :290 and Muslim 4 :2047 121 Muslim 4:2197. 131 Ahmad 3:127. * Fath Al-Bari 6 :419 and Muslim 4 :2160

ij! jA A f> ~.' ^ ;^I» -laij-j pi <iil iji>- UJ B pi p Jr Csi^j i >^~^ [J* j** J*>-3 (*r U f4~! ^rj ii'3* '3-Ljji »Vya : Jli ?*Vp>^ 4*3 iE' •J Jli; 3il>jj^ ^Slt _^>-I (J^~j !-L& ! JI3 ?JLa i_jj ^l :JU aIIIC- •j '~aj jjj v^j ^ji :JU -Jli ?>^1p O-bb- j^5j vjj : Jli jjb Cr? (Tip j' : Jli o3»Jl dL> oSli- pi 3^~ lli ,lr? o'o ojL>tAi pi jl«J : Jli VsJVl Ji2l lfk«j p ji : Jli i^ . j_p3' t'^ ,*£*? ; j r : >-r . t - - »»?»? • , .. J-7 :- «OjJ OJk>o fj 'Ja^j OjJ C__^ (Ol «W/icii A//fl/? created Adam, He wiped Adam's back and every person that He luill create from him until the Day of Resurrection fell out from his back. Allah placed a glimmering light between the eyes of each one of them. Allah showed them to Adam and Adam asked, 'O Lord! Who are they?' Allah said, 'These are your offspring.' Adam saw a man from among them whose light he liked. He asked, 'O Lord! Wlw is this man?' Allah said, 'This is a man from the latter generations of your offspring. His name is Ddwud.' Adam said, 'O Lord! How many years would he live?' Allah said, 'Sixty years.' Adam said, 'O Lord! I have forfeited forty years from my life for hint.' When Adam's life came to an end, the angel of death came to him (to take his soul). Adam said, 7 still have forty years from my life term, don't I? He said, 'Have you not given it to your son Ddwud?' So Adam denied that and his offspring followed suit (denying Allah's covenant), Adam forgot and his offspring forgot, Adam made a mistake and his offspring made mistakes .» At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan Sahih, and it was reported from various chains of narration through Abu Hurayrah from the Prophet Al-Hakim also recorded it in his Mustadrak, and said; "Sahih according to the criteria of Muslim, and they did not record it."12 ' These and similar Hadiths testify that Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, brought forth Adam's offspring from his loins Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :457 121 Al-Hakim 2:325.

203 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (172 - 174) (Part-9) and separated between the inhabitants of Paradise and those of the Fire. Allah then said, ^ if 4<md made 1/jem testify as to themselves (saying): "Am I not your Lord?" They said: "Yes!"} Therefore, Allah made them testify with themselves by circumstance and words. Testimony is sometimes given in words, such as, if txji iThey will say: "We bear witness against ourselves."} [6:130] At other times, testimony is given by the people themselves, such as Allah's statement, (*\$4*1 if J of 4/1 is not for the Mushrikin, (polytheists) to maintain the mosques of Allah, while they testify against their own selves of disbelief.} [9:17] This Ayah means that their disbelief testifies against them, not that they actually testify against themselves here. Another Ayah of this type is Allah's statement. 4And to that he bears witness (by his deeds).\$ [100:7] The same is the case with asking, sometimes takes the form of words and sometimes a situation or circumstance. For instance,

Allah said, {And He gave you of all that you asked for.} [14:34] Allah said here, {lest you should say}, on the Day of Resurrection {I was one of those who were of this} of Tawhid

205 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (175 - 177) (Part-9) said, "He is Sayfi, son of Ar-Rahib." Qatadah commented that Ka'b said, "He was a man from Al-Balqla' (a province of Jordan) who knew Allah's Greatest Name. He used to live in Bayt Al-Maqdis with the tyrants." Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He is BaTam bin Ba'ura', a man from Yemen whom Allah had given the knowledge of His Ayat, but he abandoned them." Malik bin Dinar said, "He was one of the scholars of the Children of Israel whose supplication was acceptable. They used to seek his lead in supplication in times of difficulty. Allah's Prophet Musa sent him to the King of Madyan to call him to Allah. That king appeased him and gave him land and gifts, and he reverted from the religion of Musa and followed the king's religion." Imran bin TJaynah narrated that 'Husayn said that Imran bin Al-Harith said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He is BaTam son of Ba'ura'." 2, Similar was said by Mujahid and 'Ikrimah 3 Therefore, it is well-known that this honorable Ayah was revealed about a man from the Children of Israel in ancient times, according to Ibn Mas'ud and several others among the Salaf. 41 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He is a man from the city of the tyrants (Jerusalem) whose name was BaTam and who knew Allah's Greatest Name." 151 'Ali bin Abi Talhah also reported that Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "When Musa and those with him went to the city of the tyrants (Jerusalem), the cousins of BaTam and his people came to him and said, 'Musa is a strong man, and he has many soldiers. If he gains the upper hand over us, we will be destroyed. Therefore, supplicate to Allah that He prevents Musa and those with him from prevailing over us.' BaTam said, 'If I supplicate to Allah that He turns back Musa and those with him, I will lose in this life and the Hereafter.' They kept luring him until he supplicated against Musa and his people, and Allah took away what he bestowed on him (of knowledge). Hence Allah's statement, At-Tabari 13:261. At-Tabari 13:253. At-Tabari 13:254. ' At-Tabari 13:253 ,s| At-Tabari 13:258.

206 Tahir Ibtisam Kathir 4:141 {And he threw them away; so Shaytan followed him up}''' 11] Allah said next, {And had We willed, We would surely have elevated him therewith but he clung to the earth and followed his own vain desires. Allah said, 124 {And had We willed, We would surely have elevated him therewith} from the filth of this earthly life through the Ayat that We gave him knowledge of, {but he clung to the earth}, he became interested in the adornment of this life and its delights. He indulged in the lusts of life and its joys and was deceived by it, just as life deceived others like him, without sound comprehension or a good mind. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar narrated from Salim, from Abu An-Nadr that when Musa entered the land of Bani Canaan in the area of Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), the people of Bal'am came to him, saying, "This is Musa, son of Imran with the Children of Israel. He wants to drive us out from our land, kill us and replace us with the Children of Israel. We are your people and have no other dwelling area. You are a person whose supplication is acceptable (to Allah), so go out and supplicate to Allah against them." He said, "Woe to you! Here is Allah's Prophet (Musa) with whom the angels and believers are! How can I supplicate against them when I know from Allah what I know?" They said, "We have no other dwelling area." So they kept luring and begging him until he was tempted by the trial and went on his donkey towards Mount Husban, which was behind the Israelite military barracks. When he proceeded At-Tabari 13:260.

207 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (175 - 177) (Part-9) on the Mount for a while, the donkey sat down and refused to proceed. He got off the donkey and struck it until it stood up again and he rode it. The donkey did the same after a little while, and he struck it again until it stood up... So he proceeded and tried to supplicate against Musa and his people. However, Allah made his tongue mention his people with evil and the Children of Israel with good instead of his people, who protested, "O Bal'am! What are you doing? You are supplicating for them and against us!" He said, "It is against my will. This is a matter that Allah has decided." He then said to them, as his tongue was made to loll out of his mouth, "Now I have lost this life and the Hereafter." This Ayah was revealed about the story of BaTam son of BaTira' 4^44 jiliu ilyX zsM b iAnd recite to them the story of him to whom We gave Our Ayat, but he threio them aivay .} , until. iperhaps they may reflect. Allah said next, iSo his parable is the parable of a dog : ifyou drive him aivay, he pants, or ifyou leave him alone, he (still) pants.} Scholars of Tafsir have conflicting opinions regarding the meaning of this Ayah. Some scholars said that it refers to the end of Bal'am's tongue which flickered out of his mouth, as in the stoiy narrated from Ibn Ishaq, from Salim, from Abu An- Nadr.m Therefore, his example is the example of the dog, its tongue pants regardless of whether it is driven away or not. It was also said that the meaning here is a parable of this man - and his like - concerning their misguidance, persisting the wrong path and not being able to benefit from faith or comprehend what they are being called to. So his example is that of a dog which pants whether it was driven away or left alone. The person described here does not benefit from the m At-Tabari 13:265.

209 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (177 - 178) (Part-9) commanded them to follow him. Therefore, whoever among them defies the knowledge in their Books or hides it from the servants, Allah will place disgrace on him in this life, followed by humiliation in the Hereafter. Allah said, 4&4L Ijllr o=gSt iEvil is the parable of the people who rejected Our Ayat> Allah says, evil is the example of the people who deny Our Ayat in that they are equated with dogs that have no interest but to collect food and satisfy lusts.' Therefore, whoever goes out of the area of knowledge and guidance, and seeks satisfaction for his lusts and vain desires, is just like a dog; what an evil example. The Sahth recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, iThe evil example is not suitable Jor us: he who goes back on his gift is just like the dog that eats its vomit. s' 11 Allah's statement, 0&& \jt iand they used to wrong themselves.} means, Allah did not wrong them, but they wronged themselves by rejecting guidance, not obeying the Lord, being content with this life that will soon end, all the while seeking to fulfill desires and obey lusts. 4178. Whomsoever Allah guides, he is the guided one, and whomsoever He sends astray, - then those! They are the losers.} Allah says, whomever He leads aright, then none can lead him to misguidance, and whomever He leads astray, will have acquired failure, loss and sure misguidance. Verily, whatever Allah wills occurs; and whatever He does not will, does not occur. A Hadith narrated from 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud reads, , >*S , > . ; I, • .1' w 1 ; 'ti * im JAJ L-iil fjA jiiL 0 0-U>u j[ji JLf-itj iSl «*»• JLi; {/'J ^ Ir* 1 111 Fath Al-Bari 5 :288 .

V '.JJ.) 4)1 VI Ul V jl J " »> '* l* ' > y*jj sXs* \ «All praise is due to Allah, Whom we praise and seek help, guidance and forgiveness from We seek refuge with Al- lah from the evils within ourselves and from the burden of our evil deeds. He xuhom Allah guides, iwill never be misled and he whom He misguides, will never have one who will guide him. I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah without partners and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger.» The complete Hadlth was collected by Imam Ahmad and the collectors of Sunan and others. jr wt &sm5 ujiti rj&Vtf&j lj

And surely, We have created many of the Jinn and mankind for Hell. They have hearts wherewith they understand not, and they have eyes wherewith they see not, and they have ears wherewith they hear not (the truth). They are like cattle, nay even more astray; those! They are the heedless ones.} Ahmad 1:392, Abu Dawud 2:591, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:237, An-Nasal 3 :105 and Ibn Majah 1 :609.

221 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (179) (Part-9) Disbelief and the Divine Decree Allah said, 'And surely, We have created for Hell> We made a share in the Fire for, many of the Jinn and mankind} We prepared them for it by their performance of the deeds of its people. When Allah intended to create the creation, He knew what their work will be before they existed. He wrote all this in a Book, kept with Him, fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and earth. Muslim recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «Verily, Allah decided the destination and due measurement of the creation fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and earth, and His Throne was over the water. There are many Hadiths on this subject, and certainly, the matter of Al-Qadar is of utmost importance, yet this is not where we should discuss it. Allah said, 'They have hearts wherewith they understand not, and they have eyes wherewith they see not, and they have ears wherewith they hear not.' meaning, they do not benefit from these senses that Allah made for them as a means of gaining guidance. Similarly, Allah said. 'And We had assigned them the (faculties of) hearing, seeing, and hearts; but their hearing, seeing, and their hearts availed Muslim 4 :2044.

them nothing since they used to deny the Ayat [46:26]. Allah also said about the hypocrites, 'They are) deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path)} (2: 18], and about the disbelievers, 'They are) deaf, dumb and blind. So they do not understand [2:171] However, they are not deaf, dumb or blind, except relation to the guidance. Allah said; 'Had Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even if He had made them listen, they would but have turned away with aversion (to the truth) [8:23], or" 'Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind> [22:46], and, 'And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious (Allah), We appoint for him Shaytan to be an intimate companion to him. And verily, they hinder them from the path, but they think that they are guided aright! [43:36-37] Allah's statement, 'They are like cattle>, means, those who neither hear the truth, nor understand it, nor see the guidance, are just like grazing cattle that do not benefit from these senses, except for what sustains their life in this world. Allah said in a similar Ayah,

'The example of those who disbelieve is as that of one who shouts to those who hear nothing but calls and cries .) [2:171] meaning, their example, when they are called to the faith, is the example of cattle that hear only the voice of their shepherd, but cannot understand what he is saying. Allah further described them (nay even more astray), than cattle, because cattle still respond to the call of their shepherd, even though they do not understand what he is saying. As for the people described here, they are unlike cattle, which fulfill the purpose and service they were created for. The disbeliever was created to worship Allah alone in Tawhid, but he disbelieved in Allah and associated others in His worship. Therefore, those people who obey Allah are more honorable than some angels, while cattle are better than those who disbelieve in Him. So Allah said; 'They are like cattle, nay even more astray;

those! They are the heedless ones.) \yr ^>yy. \$ \j% £21 t&Vi as) 4180. And (all) tite Most Beautiful Names belong to Allah, so call on Him by them, and leave the company of those who belie His Names. They will be requited for what they used to do.) Allah's Most Beautiful Names Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, jo S^J 4^?^*^ 'yj l o * I A 'jj *jj\ LsA Verily, Allah has ninety-nine Names, a hundred less one; whoever counts (and preserves) them, will enter Paradise. Allah is Witr (One) and loves Al-Witr (the odd numbered things)

224 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Two Sahths collected this Hadith.^ We should state that Allah's Names are not restricted to only ninety-nine. For instance, in his Musnad, Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah said; i.ikd y\ ilble '^ii\ :JU> jy- U \jJ-\ dL<>i U« *i c-m JIJ ja jd-l JSL Jlltii ilijLai Jju- nilliU- U hsL ^ ti J* dliL*-y die j\ JjLl!S ^ idyl j\ dUi; dtajj t cijy >- jyj giJ ^ j»«l l j'^l iijle Jail} -u-sj <ul daii V] 1^,1 "Any person who is overcome by sadness or grief and supplicates, 'O Allah! I am Your servant, son of Your female servant. My forelock is in Your Hand. Your decision concerning me shall certainly come to pass. Just is Your Judgement about me. I invoke You by every Name that You have and that You called Yourself by, sent down in Your Book, taught to any of Your creatures, or kept with You in the knowledge of the Unseen that is with You . Make the Glorious Qur'an the spring of my heart, the light of my chest, the remover of my grief and the dissipater of my concern.' Surely, Allah will remove his grief and sadness and exchange them for delight . The Prophet sg was asked "O Messenger of Allah! Should we learn these words?" He said, ji ja J£J "Yes. It is an obligation on all those who hear this supplication to learn it. »121 Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, iand leave the company of those who belie His Names} "To belie Allah's Names includes saying that Al-Lat (an idol) Fath Al-B&ri 5 :417 and 11 :218 and Muslim 4:2062. Ahmad 1 :391

215 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (180 - 181) (Part-9) derived from Allah's Name."111 Ibn Jurayj narrated from Mujahid that he commented, iand leave the company of those who belie His Names ^ "They derived Al-Lat (an idol's name) from Allah, and Al-'Uzza (another idol) from Al-'Aziz (the All-Mighty)." 121 Qatadah stated that Ilhdd refers to associating others with Allah in His Names (such as calling an idol Al-Vzzd)}3^ The word Ilhdd (used in the Ayah in another from) means deviation, wickedness, injustice and straying. The hole in the grave is called Lahd, because it is a hole within a hole, that is turned towards the Qiblah (the direction of the prayer). 4181. And of those whom We have created, there is a community who guides (others) with the truth, and establishes justice therewith. Allah said, 4And of those whom We have created}, in reference to some nations, iiA} 4a community}, that stands in truth, in words and action, iwhoguides (others) with the truth}, they proclaim it and call to it, 4and establishes justice therewith}, adhere to it themselves and judge by it. It was reported that this Ayah refers to the Ummah of Muhammad sg. In the Two SahOis, it is recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan said that the Messenger of Allah £jg said, At-Tabari 13:282. 121 At-Tabari 13:283. 131 At-Tabari 13:283.

'jj N J>Jl Iji* J* <i3U» Jlj l V» •UllJl py£ oThere will always be a group of my Ummah who are apparent on the Truth, unabated by those who fail or oppose them, until the (Last) Hour commences .« In another narration, the Messenger §gr said, •ilJi ji. 4)1 y\\$ JU-> *Until Allah's command (the Last Hour) comes while they are still like this .» and in yet another narration, •pilli •And they will dwell in Ash-Sham (Greater Syria). s* 11 oj#\\$ V « p&*££ filT <1S2. Those who reject Our Ayat, We shall

gradually seize them with punishment in ways they perceive not.} 4183. And I respite them; certainly My plan is strong.} Allah said, 4%o^i * o; ^ 4Those who reject Our Ayat, We shall gradually seize them in ways they perceive not} meaning, the doors of provisions will be opened for them and also the means of livelihood, in this life. They will be deceived by all this and think that they are on the correct path. Allah said in another instance, Vyj\ \f>.j ij| jj*. £ 'j— «jw A. !>JbJt pi 2* p£^ 4So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of every (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden, We took them (in punishment) and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets m Fath Al-Bari 13:451 and Muslim 3:1524.

and sorrow. So the root of the people who did wrong was cut off. And all the praises and thanks are to Allah, the Lord of all that exists>[6:44-45]. Allah said here, iAnd I respite them} prolong what they are in, i oj) icertainly My plan is strong and perfect. <254. Do they not reflect? There is no madness in their companion. He is but a plain wamer.} Allah said, 4Do they not reflect?} ‘those who deny Our Ayat,’ ithere is not in their companion}, Muhammad sg, iU*& imadness Muhammad is not mad, rather, he is truly the Messenger of Allah, calling to Truth, ibut he is a plain wamer}, and this is clear for those who have a mind and a heart by which they understand and comprehend. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And (O people) your companion is not a madman.}[81:22] Allah also said, 1yj* o» \J US} Jif oj* 'J* f>l 4Say : "I exhort you to one (thing) only, that you stand up for

Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion . He is only a wamer to you in face of a severe torment."} [34:46] meaning, 1 ask you to stand for Allah in sincerity without stubbornness or bias,' iin pairs and singly} [34:46] individuals and in groups, iand reflect [34:46], about this man who brought the Message from Allah, is he mad? If you do this, it will become clear to you that he is the Messenger of Allah in truth and justice. Qatadah bin Di'amah said, “We were informed that the Prophet of Allah H once was on (Mount) As-Safa and called the Quraysh, subtribe by subtribe, proclaiming, «0 Children of so-and-so, O Children of so-and-so! He warned them against Allah's might and what He has done (such as revenge from His enemies) Some of them commented, This companion of yours (Prophet Muhammad) is mad; he kept shouting until the morning?’ Allah sent down this Ayah, 4D0 they not reflect? There is no tnadness in their companion. He is but a plain wamer} [7:184].” Ji Sjs jl fly OJ^ ^ 4185. Do they not look in the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all things that Allah has created; and that it may be that the end of their lives is near. In what message after this will they then believe?} 1*1 At-T®l)ari 13 :289. This narration is not authentic. Al-BukhSri (nos. 4770 -1) recorded a similar story about the revelation of Ayah 214 of Surat Ash-Shu‘ar&’ (26) and Surat Al-Masad (111).

219 Surah 7. Al-A'rdf (185 - 186) (Part-9) Allah asks, those who denied faith, did they not contemplate about Our Ayat in the kingdom of the heavens and earth and what was created in them? Do they not contemplate about all this and learn lessons from it, so that they are certain that He Who has all this, has no equal or rival? All this was made by He Who Alone deserves the worship and sincere religion, so that they might have faith in Him and believe in His Messenger, all the while turning to Allah's obedience, rejecting any rivals to Him, and rejecting idols. They should be warned that their lives may have reached their end, and they, thus, face their demise while disbelievers, ending up in Allah's

torment and severe punishment. Allah said. *iltt* what message after this will they then believe?> Allah says, what more warnings, and discouragements should compel them to believe, if the warnings and threats that Muhammad *jg* brought them from Allah in His Book do not compel them to do so? Allah said next, *itf&I'* 4 *lit il*86. *Wltomsoever* Allah sends astray, none can guide him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgressions.> Allah says, those who were destined to be misguided, then none can lead them to guidance, and even if they *tiy* their best effort to gain such guidance, this will not avail them, *iAnd* whomsoever Allah wants to put in *Fitnah* (error, because of his rejecting of Faith, or trial), you can do nothing *far* him against *Allalfy* [5:41], and, *iSay*: "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth," but neither *Aydt* nor *wamers* benefit those who believe not> [10 :101]. 4 *Jjl % rJi v % te oCl #£lf £ c&j \$ Zt- jf- <\$> iZ yj y*

220 *Tafstr Ibn Kathir* 4 *ojtli j&* 4187. They ask you about the Hour (Day of Resurrection): "When will be its appointed time?" *Say*: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord (Alone). None can reveal its time but He. Heavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden." They ask you as if you have a good knowledge of it. *Say*: "The knowledge thereof is with Allah (Alone), but most of mankind know not."4 The Last Hour and its Portents Allah said here, 4They ask you about the Hour}, just as He said in another *Ayah* *iPeople* ask you concerning the Hour} (33:63). It was said that this *Ayah* was revealed about the Quraysh or the Jews, although it appears that it was about the Quraysh, because this *Ayah* was revealed in Makkah. The Quraysh used to ask about the Last Hour, because they used to deny it and discount its coming. For instance, Allah said in another *Ayah*, 4And they say : "When will be this promise (the torment or the Day of Resurrection), if you speak the truth?"} [10:48], and, ¥ 0 *ip jp: S£3> v pit ip ie\li\ j* 'dj/jCL *i/M o* 4Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth. Verily, those who dispute concerning the Hour are certainly in error~~jar~~ away} [42:18], Allah said here (that the Quraysh asked), 4V>> '&}

221 *Surah 7. Al-A'rdf*(187) (Part-9) *i*"When will be its appointed time?") in reference to its commencement, according to 'Ali bin Abi Talhah who reported this from Ibn 'Abbas.¹¹¹ They asked about the Hour's appointed term and when the end of this world will begin; is "Im Qf. V Sj *l£L LiJ \$*) *iSay*: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord (Alone). None can reveal its time but He.") Allah commanded His Messenger *jg* that when asked about the appointed term of the Last Hour, he referred its knowledge to Allah, the Exalted. Only Allah knows the Last Hour's appointed term and when it will certainly occur, and none besides Him has this knowledge, *iLM* 4 *iHeavy* is its burden through the heavens and the earth 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah commented on this *Ayah*, *i<j\$ * 4 *era*) *iHeavy* is its burden through the heavens and the earth) "Its knowledge is heavy on the residents of the heavens and earth, they do not have knowledge in it." 121 Also, Ma'mar said that Al-Hasan commented on this *Ayah*, "When the Last Hour comes, it will be heavy on the residents of the heavens and earth." (3) Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas explained this *Ayah*, *iLM* 4 *iHeavy* is its burden through the heavens and the earth,) saying, "All creatures will suffer its heaviness on the Day of Resurrection." Ibn Jurayj also said about this *Ayah*, *iHeavy* is its burden through the heavens and the earth.) At-Tabari 13:294. 121 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :244 131 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :245

“When it commences, the heavens will be torn, the stars will scatter all over, the sun will be wound round (thus losing its light), the mountains will be made to pass away and all of which Allah spoke of will occur. This is the meaning of its burden being heavy.” As-Suddi said that, its burden through the heavens and the earth means, its knowledge is hidden in the heavens and earth, and none, not even a close angel or a sent Messenger has knowledge of its appointed time. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden indicating that the Hour will start all of a sudden, while they are unaware. Qatadah said, “Allah has decided that, it shall not come upon you except all of a sudden. He then said, “We were informed that Allah’s Prophet (ﷺ) said, - it, • •! * > "a**JL) o’jri yj, (•-•! «The Hour will start (suddenly) for the people while one is mending his watering hole, giving water to his cattle, setting his goods in the market or lowering his scale and raising it (selling and buying) Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said. o’dll lily <i-ilt ili » l^y -4 ft Jr yj. jt p Lli ‘ Nj t a*1—Jl Ir4 L Ify&j i*4iiu 'fi a~>»a1 iff*. *-» 111 At-Tabari 13:295. ,2' At-Tabari 13:297. The meaning of this narration is supported by the following Hadith

223 Surah 7. Al-A’r’df (187) (Part-9 j\ >*) jfjh) is-'-Ul <.4J jaj; y>'j UlUl «The Hour will not commence until the sun rises from the west. When it rises (from the west) and the people see it, then, all people will believe. However, this is when faith does not benefit a soul that did not believe beforehand nor earned good in faith. The Hour will (all of a sudden) commence while two men have spread a garment between them, and they will neither have time to conclude the transaction nor to fold the garment. The Hour will commence after a man milked his animal, but he will not have time to drink it. The Hour will start when a man is making his watering hole (for his animals), but will not have time to make use of the pool. And the Hour will commence while a man has raised his hand with a bite to his mouth, but will not eat it ,»[11 Al-‘Awfi said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, iThey ask you as if you have good knowledge of it.> “As if you have good relations and friendship with them!” Ibn ‘Abbas said, “When the people (pagans of Quraysh) asked the Prophet about the Last Hour, they did so in a way as if Muhammad was their friend! Allah revealed to him that its knowledge is with Him Alone and He did not inform a close angel or Messenger of it.” 121 The correct explanation for this Ayah is, as narrated from Mujahid, through Ibn Abi Najih, iQZ Iff iThey ask you as if you have Hafiz of it.f means, ‘as if you had asked about its time and so its knowledge is with you.’ Allah said, y "jfr 33;& i* Cfc& iSay : "The knowledge thereof is with Allah (Alone), but most [1? Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :360 121 At-Tabari 13:298.

of mankind know not.”} When Jibril came in the shape of a bedouin man to teach the people matters of their religion, he sat next to the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) asking him as if to learn. Jibril asked the Messenger (ﷺ) about Islam, then about Iman (faith) then about Ihsan (Excellence in the religion). He asked next, “When will the Hour start?” Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) said, oJJlUl^ lp. «He who is asked about it has no more knowledge of it than the questioner .» Therefore, the Prophet (ﷺ) was saying, I have no more knowledge in it than you (O Jibril), nor does anyone have more knowledge in it than anyone else.’ The Prophet (ﷺ) then recited the Ayah, jtie Jx* -Jit 5^ iVerily, Allah, with Him (Alone) is the knowledge of the Hour.} [31:34] In another narration, Jibril asked the Prophet about the portents of the Hour, and the Prophet (ﷺ) mentioned them. The Prophet (ﷺ) also said in this narration, «iii Yj Y J? «Five, their knowledge is only with Allah » then recited this Ayah (31:34). In response to the Prophet’s answers after each question, Jibril would say, “You have said the truth.” This made the Companions wonder about this questioner who would ask a question and attest to every answer he was given. When Jibril

went away, the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} said to the Companions, «77ijs is Jibril, he came to teach you matters of your religion .» In yet another narration, the Prophet[^] commented, IfJ d'jf. Yj ;JJ~0 ^5* UjB </ recognized him (Jibril) in every shape he came to me in, except this one. s' 11 m Fath Al-Bdri 1 :140.

225 Surah 7. Al-A'raf(187) (Part-9 Muslim recorded that 'Aishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said; "When the bedouins used to come to the Prophet jg, they used to ask him about the Hour. The Prophet jg would answer them, while pointing at the youngest person among them, «// this (young man) lives, he will not become old before your Hour starts. The Prophet ^{sg} meant the end of their life that introduces them to the life in Barzakh, which is between this life and the Hereafter. Muslim recorded that Anas said that a man asked Allah's Messenger jg about the Hour, and the Messenger ^{sg} answered, *SjJb V jf "If this young boy lives, it might be tmt he will not become old before the Hour startsJ*21 Only Muslim collected this Hadith. Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah ^saying, one month before he died, 'jill Lfilp UJJ3 ^C- «Yom fceep asfa'ng we about the Hour, when its knowledge is with Alldh. I swear by Allah that there is no living soul on the face of the earth now will be alive a hundred years from now. Muslim collected this Hadith. A similar Hadith is recorded in Two Sahihs from Ibn 'Umar, but he commented, "The Messenger of Allah gg meant that his generation will be finished by that time reach its appointed term." Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said that the Prophet jg said, - Jii - UliJi y\ ^ t u) (*-4 V : (Jlii i^^LUL tSe. IjI'ji ^rrrTi ^ : cr-rf 'jV ^ J f-4 N y ^ Muslim 4:2269 121 Muslim 4:2270.

jf J>-j > t)\ •*t*' ' j* <*>' •*>' 4! ^ : Jli lijij^ 4^ liji tj**j - Jli - j -jU- l^ilJ <1)| lj :Jj* 3**^'^ ^! Lf*~ </ib 'H ij\ ,3-&' g-3; J43 3 »>^ki* *-^ nkiU kl)Jiiali iQjl ...t *—J-X>- ^jA JUj ^>«j kiiJi x*4 : Jli jw : Jli : *y.s* ^! i^ 6 Jjj*i ° 'ij ^ ^ p-&~> J^j > r+'jQ? o-^ 1 c?3i ')a^\ fe-j> iiii Jj4* ^Or1 rt^iJ Cr' Ji u^J^ lS3** Xwj JII>JI >-i'-i jvJ "Ojjl* {J. Jjji • t#5 j^AjLI^f 3* Jj ***** ^ '(*~*® 4J.^ JI P <J^3^ ^ l*Uf ^ji: 'tf jyj> J-UJtf fcllJl 1\$ iSiiZ h\\$ \i\ JIJ a of ^3 «i3tf jf ii;W>. ^-u; «During the night of Isrd', I met Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa. They mentioned the matter of the Last Hour, and they asked Ibrahim about it, who said, 'I do not have knowledge of it.' They asked Musa about it and he said, 'I have no knowledge of it.' They then asked 'Isa about it, and he said, 'As for when it will occur, only Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, knows that. My Lord has conveyed to me that the Dajjal (False Messiah) will appear, and I will have two staffs (spears) with me. When he sees me, he will dissolve just as lead is dissolved. Allah will destroy him when he sees me, and the tree and the stone will say, 'O Muslim! There is a disbeliever under (behind) me, so come and kill him.' Allah will destroy them (the Dajjal and his army), and the people will safely go back to their lands and areas. Tlxereafter, Gog and Magog will appear, and they will be swarming from every mound, sweeping over the earth and destroying everything they pass by. Tlxcy will drink every water source they pass. The people will come to me complaining about Gog and Magog and will invoke Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, against them, and Allah will bring death to all of them until the earth rots with their stinking odor. Allah will send down rain on them and the rain will carry their corpses,

until it throws them in the sea... My Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored has conveyed to me that when this occurs, the Hour will be just like the pregnant women when the term of pregnancy is full, her family does not know when she will surprise them and give birth, whether by night or by day.ii111 Ibn Majah also collected a similar Hadith '2) Therefore these are the greatest of the Messengers but they did

not have knowledge of the appointed term of the Hour. They asked Isa about it and he spoke about its Signs, since he will descend in the last generations of this Ummah, implementing the Law of Allah's Messenger ﷺ, killing the Dajjal and destroying Gog and Magog people by the blessing of his supplication. Isa merely informed them of the knowledge Allah gave him on this subject. Imam Ahmad recorded that Hudhayfah said, "The Messenger of Allah was asked about the Hour and he said, 4 A Ife. j! ' l *Its knowledge is with my Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, none can reveal its time except Him. However, I will tell you about its portents and the signs that precede it. Before it commences, there will be Fitnah (trials) and Harj.i They asked, 'O Allah's Messenger! We know the meaning of the Fitnah, so what is the Haij?' He said, jtXi «Jf means killing, in the Language of the Ethiopians . » He then said, jZ jj.\ £ jfo, «Isolation and loneliness will be common between people, and therefore, almost no one will be able to recognize any other None among the collectors of the six Sunan collected this Hadith using this chain of narration. Tariq bin Shihab said m Ahmad 1 :375. 121 Ibn Mfijah 2:1365. 131 Ahmad 5:389.

that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ kept mentioning the Last Hour [for people kept asking about it], until this Ayah was revealed, iThey ask you about the Hour (Day of Resurre- tion): "When will be its appointed time?".TM An-Nasa'i collected this Hadith , (21 which has a strong chain. Therefore, this unlettered Prophet jg, the chief of the Messengers and their Seal, Muhammad, may Allah's peace and blessings be on him, Muhammad, the Prophet of mercy, repentance, Al- Malhmah (great demise of the disbelievers), Al-'Aqib (who came after many Prophets), Al-MuqafB (the last of a succession) and Al-Hashir (below whom will all people be gathered [on the Day of Gathering]) Muhammad sg who said, as collected in the Sahih from Anas and Sahl bin Sa'd, '*£ID I j Iji CJaj «My sending and the Hour are like this,n and he joined his index and middle fingers.!3 ^ Yet, he was commanded to defer knowledge of the Last Hour to Allah if he was asked about it, 111 At-Tabari 3 :292 TM An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra:6 :506. 131 Fath Al-Bdri 1 1 :355 - > > wo i ^j'4e * A ss j? A A A A ^ ^p (wp jj)Aj j

Sura}i 7. Al-A'rdf (188) (Part-9) 229 1J& sa; u x* a* \$} iSay: "The knowledge thereof is with Allah (alone), but most of mankind know not."} Si C3Kp JTT jjj& it* {.li&"Tja ^ dp "v ji> ^ \a s> ^ us pt 4188. Say : "I possess no power over benefit or harm to myself except as Alldlt wills. If I had the knowledge of the Ghayb (Unseen), I should have secured for myself an abundance of wealth, and no evil should have touched me. I am but a wamer, and a bringer of glad tidings unto people who believe."} The Messenger sg does not know the Unseen, and He cannot bring Benefit or Harm even to Himself Allah commanded His Prophet jg to entrust all matters to Him and to inform, about himself, that he does not know the unseen future, but he knows of it only what Allah informs him. Allah said in another Ayah, i:«:& *s sr-Uif 4(He Alone is) the All-Knower of the Ghayb (Unseen), and He reveals to none His Ghayb.} [72:26] Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4If I had the knowledge of the Ghayb (Unseen), I should have securedfor myselfan abundance ofwealth.} refers to money. In another narration, Ibn 'Abbas commented, "I would have knowledge of how much profit I would make with what I buy, and I would always sell what I would make profit from, 4"and no evil should have touched me."} and poverty would never touch me." ,1] Ibn Jarir said, "And others said. This means Ad-DurrAl-Manthur3 :622

that if I know the Unseen then I would prepare for the years of famine during the prosperous years, and in the time of high cost, I would have prepared for it.” ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam also commented on this Ayah; ‘‘and no evil should have touched me.’’, ‘‘I would have avoided and saved myself from any type of harm before it comes.’’ 11 ‘ Allah then stated that the Prophet is a wamer and bearer of good news. He warns against the torment and brings good news of Paradise for the believers, ‘‘So We have made this (the Qur’an) easy on your tongue, only that you may give glad tidings to the pious, and warn with it the most quarrelsome of people.’’ [19:97] ‘‘If You give us a Salih (good in every aspect) child, we shall indeed be among the grateful.’’ 4190. But when He gave them a Salih child, they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them. High be Allah, Exalted above all that they ascribe as partners to Him.} All Mankind are the Offspring of Adam Allah states that He has created all mankind from Adam, m At-Tabari 13:302.

231 Surah 7. Al-A’raf (189 - 190) (Part-9) peace be upon him, and from Adam, He created his wife, Hawwa’ and from them, people started to spread. Allah said in another Ayah, ‘‘O mankind! We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into nations and tribes, that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable of you with Allah is that (believer) who has Taqwa (49:13), and. It is He Who created you from a single person, and from him He created his wife.’’ [4:1] In this honorable Ayah, Allah said; ‘‘And (then) He has created from him his wife, in order that he might enjoy the pleasure of living with her.’’ so that he is intimate and compassionate with her. Allah said in another Ayah, ‘‘And among His Signs is this, that He created for you wives (spouses) from among yourselves, that you may find repose in them, and He has put between you affection and mercy.’’ [30:21] Indeed, there is no intimacy between two souls like that between the spouses. This is why Allah mentioned that the sorcerer might be able with his trick to separate between a man and his wife [thus indicating the difficulty of separating them in normal circumstances]. Allah said next, ‘‘When I covered her’’ meaning had sexual intercourse with her.

‘‘And she became pregnant and she carried it about lightly’’ in reference to the first stage of pregnancy when the woman does not feel pain, for at that time, the fetus will be just a Nutfah (the mixture of the male and female discharge), then becomes an ‘Alaqah (a piece of thick coagulated blood) and then a Mudghah (a small lump of flesh). Allah said next, ‘‘and she carried it about’’, she continued the pregnancy, according to Mujahid. * It was reported that Al-Hasan, Ibrahim An-Nakha‘1 and As-Suddi said similarly. * Maymun bin Mahran reported that his father said, ‘‘She found the pregnancy unnoticeable.’’ Ayyub said, ‘‘I asked Al-Hasan about the Ayah, ‘‘and she carried it about’’ and he said, ‘‘Had you been an Arab, you would know what it means! It means that she continued the pregnancy [through its various stages].’’*3 * Qatadah said, ‘‘and she carried it about (lightly).’’, means, it became clear that she was pregnant.*4 ‘ Ibn Jarir commented, ‘‘This Ayah means that the liquid remained, whether she stood up or sat down.’’*5 Al-‘Awfi recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, ‘‘The semen remained in, but she was unsure if she became pregnant or not, ‘‘Then when it became heavy’’, she became heavier with the fetus’’,*6 * As-Suddi said, ‘‘The fetus grew in her womb.’’*7 13) 16) At-Tabari

13:305. At-Jabari 13:304-305. At-Tabari 13:304. At-Tabari 13 :305 At-Tabari 13:304. At-Jabari 13 :305 At-Jabari 13:305.

Ojj '-'|V iil ithey both invoked Allah, their Lord (saying) : ",If You give us a Salih child,} if he is bom human in every respect. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "They feared that their child might be bom in the shape of an animal!"¹¹¹ while Abu Al-Bakhtri and Abu Malik commented, "They feared that their newborn might not be human." ¹²¹ Al-Hasan Al-Basri also commented, "If You (Allah) give us a boy." lii fcifc Zi C&K ts u Z&} iwe shall indeed be among the grateful. But when He gave them a Salih child, they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He Itas given to them. High be Allah, Exalted above all that they ascribe as partners to Him.} (7:189-190) Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Hasan commented on this part of the Ayah, 4i4£r. TL* Jj 4they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them "This occurred by followers of some religion, not from Adam [or Hawwa']." ¹⁴¹ Al-Hasan also said, "This Ayah refers to those among the offspring of Adam who fell into Shirk, 4t£x Za ithey ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them.}" ¹⁵¹ Qatadah said, "Al-Hasan used to say that it refers to the Jews and Christians. Allah gave them children, and they turned ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 13:306. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 13:306. ¹³¹ At-Tabari 13:306. At-Tabari 13:314. At-Tabari 13:314.

For cases, Allah said them into Jews and Christians." ¹¹¹ The explanations from Al-Hasan have authentic chains of narration leading to him, and certainly, it is one of the best interpretations. This Ayah should therefore be understood this way, for it is apparent that it does not refer to Adam and Hawa', but about the idolators among their offspring. Allah mentioned the person first [Adam and Hawwa'I and then continued to mention the species [mankind, many of whom committed Shirk]. There are similar cases in the Qur'an. Gj]i 53* 1^) \$And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps} It is well-known that the stars that were made as lamps in the sky are not the same as the shooting missiles that are thrown at the devils [mentioned later in the Ayah]. There are similar instances in the Qur'an. Allah knows best. m At-Tabari 13:315.

235Surah 7. Al-A'rOf (191 - 198) (Part-9 6^ ^ 4=>1 r==*Jlt*i j\J-e «*»' oj* # ^ fl^ *a^ >1^ 3>i£ ,4p •>% ££^ y*j40 4P 4' C4 ^>1 <SiU# \$ i>>4 ^ j£?£i 14 J* 'n44 pr-«^ "5lj |>fe=>jsoi 4:!?- -1 "i -A>i ui iy*2 4j' .>(Jj-. * # ^ 04# ^55; te *5 *a* jj #2 ojs :i^4^: > •> 4191. Do they attribute as partners to Allah those who created nothing but they themselves are created?} 4292. No help can they give them, nor can they help themselves. 4193. And ifyou call them to guidance, theyfollow you not. It is the samefor you whether you call them or you keep silent. 4294. Verily, those whom you call upon besides Allah are servants like you. So call upon them and let them answer you if you are truthful.} 4295. Have they feet wherewith they walk? Or have they hands wherewith they hold? Or have they eyes wherewith they see? Or have they ears wherewith they hear? Say: "Call your (so- called) partners (of Allah) and then plot against me, and give me no respite!} 4296. Verily, my protector is Allah Who has revealed the Book (the Qur'an), and He protects the righteous .} il97. And those whom you call upon besides Him (Allah) cannot help you nor can they help themselves.} 4298. And ifyou call them to guidance, they hear not and you will see them looking at you, yet they see not."} Idols do not create, help, or have Power over Anything Allah admonishes the idolators who worshipped idols, rivals and images besides Him, although these objects were created by Allah, and neither own anything nor can they bring harm or

benefit. These objects do not see or give aid to those who worship them. They are inanimate objects that neither move, hear, or see. Those who worship these objects are better than

236 Tafsir Ibtal Katlur they are, for they hear see and have strength of their own. Allah said, 'Do they attribute as partners to Allah those who created nothing but they themselves are created?' meaning, 'Do you associate with Allah others that neither create, nor have power to create anything?' Allah said in another Ayah, 'O mankind! A similitude has been coined, so listen to it (carefully): Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create (even) a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are (both) the seeker and the sought. They have not estimated Allah His rightful estimate. Verily, Allah is All-Strong, Almighty [22:73-74]. Allah states that if all false gods of the disbelievers gather their strength, they would not be able to create a fly. Rather, if the fly steals anything from them, no matter how insignificant, and flew away, they would not be able to retrieve it. Therefore, if an object is this weak, how can it be worshipped and invoked for provisions and aid? This is why Allah said, 'Who created nothing but they themselves are created?' these worshipped objects themselves were created and made. Prophet Ibrahim Al-Khalil proclaimed, 'Worship you that which you (yourselves) carve? [37:95] Allah said next, 'O Allah'

237 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (191 - 198) (Part-9) 'No help can they give them' those who worship them, nor can they help themselves nor are they able to aid themselves against those who seek to harm them. For instance, Allah's Khalil, peace be upon him, broke and disgraced the idols of his people, just as Allah said he did, 'Then he turned upon them, striking (them) with his right hand,' [37:93] and, 'So he broke them to pieces, (all) except the biggest of them, that they might turn to it.' [21:58] Mu'adh bin 'Amr bin Al-Jamuh and Mu'adh bin Jabal, may Allah be pleased with both of them, were still young when they embraced Islam after the Messenger of Allah came to Al-Madinah. So they were attacking the idols of the idolaters at night, breaking, disfiguring them and using them as fuel for needy widows. They sought to give a lesson to their people to make them aware of their error. 'Amr bin Al-Jamuh, who was one of the chiefs of his people, had an idol that he used to worship and perfume. The two Mu'adhs used to go to that idol, turn it on its head and tarnish it with animal waste. When 'Amr bin Al-Jamuh would see what happened to his idol, he would clean it, perfume it and leave a sword next to it, saying, "Defend yourself." However, the two young men would repeat their actions, and he would do the same as before. Once, they took the idol, tied it to a dead dog and threw it in a well while tied to a rope! When 'Amr bin Al-Jamuh saw this, he knew that his religion was false and said, "By Allah! Had you been a god who has might, you would not end up tied to a dog on a rope!" 'Amr bin Al-Jamuh embraced Islam, and he was strong in his Islam. He was later martyred during the battle of Uhud, may Allah be pleased with him, give him pleasure, and grant him Paradise as his dwelling. Allah said, 'And if you call them to guidance, they follow you not.'

Allah says, these idols do not hear the calls of those who worship them. Therefore, the result is the same, whether calling the idols or shunning them. Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said, 'O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?' [19:42] Next, Allah states that the idols were created, just as those who worship them. Rather, the people are better

than the idols, because they are able to hear, see and exert harm. The idols, on the other hand, have no such powers. Allah said next, iSay: "Call your (so-called) partners (of Allah invoke the idols for aid against me and do not give me respite, even for an instant, and give it your best effort. iVerily, my protector is Allah Who has revealed the Book (the Qur'an), and He protects the righteous. Allah's support is sufficient and He will suffice for me, He is My supporter, I trust in Him and take refuge with Him. He is my protector, in this life and the Hereafter, and the protector of every righteous believer after me. Similarly, the people of Hud said, ot & 4t ^ <&> at 4" All that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil (madness)." Hud replied: I call Allah to witness, and bear you witness that I am free from that which you ascribe [as partners in worship, with Him (Allah)]. So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving (living) creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on a path

239 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (191 - 198) (Part-9) that is straight > [1 1:54-56]. Ibrahim Al-Khalil proclaimed (to his people), •h 4 %\$ 2 s & * £\$> / /.'-a y />' <# //« .#4* (^U- VJ iDo you observe that which you have been worshipping, You and your ancient fathers. Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of all that exists . Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me.") [26:75-78] He also said to his father and his people, j UC ~£ff jMxr- isM i"Verily, I am innocent of what you worship. Except Him Who did create me; and verily, He will guide me." And he made it a legacy lasting among his offspring, that they may turn back (to Allah.) [43:26-28] Allah said here, ojj ot oji' iVerily, those whom you call upon besides Allah) until the end of the Ayah, reiterating what has been said earlier, but He uses direct speech this time, £8 % i) i cannot help you nor can they help themselves.) The Ayah, > •> *>•' '\\ ' >|. VJ (*A> "J] (HVj iAttd if you call them to guidance, they hear not and you will see them looking at you, yet they see not.) is similar to another Ayah, \£k v o\ ilf you invoke (or call upon) them, they hear not your call.) [35:14], Allah said next,

240 Tafstr Ibn Kathir & Js* i Y (Uj <33) r&yj¥ i and you will see them looking at you, yet they see not.> meaning, they have eyes that stare as if they see, although they are solid. Therefore, the Ayah treated them as if they had a mind [saying, Tarahum, instead of Taraha], since they are made in the shape of humans with eyes drawn on them. ffr ot 1*1j if fits C f a *' f / >*» ^*i I • * / *jJ Att\j Xfr <299. Show forgiveness , enjoin Al-'Urf (the good), and turn away from the foolish (don't punish them).} <200. And if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan, then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} Showing Forgiveness 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah's statement, <£>;•» iShow forgiveness "Allah commanded [Prophet Muhammad jg] to show forgiveness and turn away from the idolators for ten years. Afterwards Allah ordered him to be harsh with them." And more than one narration from Mujahid says, "From the [bad] behavior and actions of the people, of those who have not committed espionage."12, And Hashim bin Tjrwah said that his father said, "Allah ordered Allah's Messenger jg to pardon the people for their behavior."131 And in one narration, "pardon what I have allowed you of their behavior." In Sahih Al-Bukhari it is recorded that Hisham reported from his father Tjrwah from his brother 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr who said; "[The Ayah]; <>ii fo} iShow forgiveness} was only revealed about the peoples [bad] 1,1 At-Tabari 13:328. At-Tabari 13:327. At-Tabari 13:327.

242 Surah 7. Al-A'raf (199 - 200) (Part-9 character." There is a narration from Mughirah from Hisham from his father from Ibn 'Umar; and another from Hisham from his father from 'A'ishah, both of whom said similarly. [2] And Allah knows best. Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Yunus said that Sufyan bin 'Uyaynah narrated that Umar said, "When Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, revealed this Ayah, *show forgiveness, enjoin Al-'Urf (what is good), and turn away from the foolish to His Prophet, the Messenger of Allah*^ asked, *1Aa Li® n'What does it mean, O Jibril?*» Jibril said, 'Allah commands you to forgive those who wronged you, give to those who deprived you, and keep relations with those who cut theirs with you.'" 131 Al-Bukhari said, "Allah said, *show forgiveness, enjoin Al-'Urf and turn away from the ignorant*}. 'Al-'Urf, means, righteousness." Al-Bukhari next recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Uyaynah bin Hisn bin Hudhayfah stayed with his nephew Al-Hur bin Qays, who was among the people whom 'Umar used to have near him, for 'Umar used to like to have the reciters of the Qur'an (who memorized it) near him and would listen to their opinion, regardless of whether they were old or young men. 'Uyaynah said to his nephew, 'O my nephew! You are close to this chief ('Umar), so ask for permission for me to see him.' Al-Hur said *1 will ask him for you,' and he asked 'Umar for permission for 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :155. 121 Path Al-Bari 8:156. 131 At-Tabari 6:154 and Ibn Abi Hatim 5:1638. Its chain is not connected. Ibn Kathir said that it was recorded by others with a connected chain, and Ar-Rifal considered it authentic

Uyaynah to meet him, and Umar gave him permission. When Uyaynah entered on "Umar, he said, 'O Ibn Al-Khattab! You neither give to us sufficiently nor rule with justice between us.' Umar became so angry that he almost punished Uyaynah. However, Al-Hur said, 'O Chief of the Faithful! Allah, the Exalted, said to His Prophet jg, 4. if J°jk> *show forgiveness, enjoin Al-'Urf, and turn away from the foolish*} Verily this man (Uyaynah) is one of the fools!' By Allah, Umar did not do anything after he heard that Ayah being recited, and indeed, he was one who adhered to the Book of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored.'" Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith. Some scholars said that people are of two kinds, a good-doer, so accept his good doing and neither ask him more than he can bear nor what causes him hardship. The other kind is the one who falls in shortcomings, so enjoin righteousness on him. If he still insists on evil, becomes difficult and continues in his ignorance, then turn away from him, so that your ignoring him might avert his evilness. Allah said in other instances, . >>< \ ' * ^ t 'itf iRepel evil with that which is better. We are best-acquainted with the things they utter. And say: "My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the whisperings (suggestions) of the Shaydtn (devils). And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they should come near me.">[23:96-98] and, yUe lj^ jZ&S £*5 4^11 Yj AS J-l "jj} iThe good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal. Repel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom Fath Al-Bari 8 :155 .

\$Verily, He is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} Allah hears the ignorance that the fools subject you to, your seeking refuge with Him from the devil's whispers, and the rest of the speech of His creation; none of it escapes His knowledge. He knows what drives the lures of the devil away from you, as well as, the rest of what His creatures do." We mentioned the Hadiths concerning Isti'adhah (seeking refuge with Allah) in the beginning of this Tafsir, so we do not need to repeat them here. ^ Si 61 ^} i201. Verily, those who have Taqwa, when an evil thought comes to them from Shaytan, they remember (Allah), and (indeed) they then see (aright).} \$202. But (as for) their brothers (the devils' brothers) they (the devils) plunge them deeper into error, and they never stop short.} The Whispering of Shaytan and the People of Taqwa

Allah mentions His servants who have Taqwa, obeying His orders, and avoid what He forbade: iwhen comes to them} an evil thought, or anger, or the whispers of Shaytan cross their mind, or intend to err, or commit an error, \$they remember} Allah's punishment, as well as, His tremendous reward. They remember Allah's promises and threats, then repent, go back to Him, seek refuge with Him and ask for forgiveness before death, (Jk At-Tabari 13:332.

Li ^4 <l~.fi elk* ijC ^ Lii ilfWe will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility.} [26:4] The pagans asked the Prophet, why did you not strive hard to bring us an Ayah (miracle) from Allah so that we witness it and believe in it. Allah said to him, 4^j oi &[Sri ^ 4Say : "I butfollow what is revealed to mefrom my Lord/"} I do not ask such things of my Lord. I only follow what He reveals and commands me. Therefore, if Allah sends a miracle, I will accept it. Otherwise, I will not ask for it unless He allows me. Certainly, Allah is Most Wise, the All-Knower. Allah next directs the servants to the fact that this Qur'an is the most powerful miracle, clearest evidence and most true proofand explanation, saying, 0? \-k±kf iThis (the Qur'an) is nothing but evidences from your Lord, and a guidance and a mercyfor a people who believe.} 4204. So, when the Qur'an is recited, listen to it, and be silent that you may receive mercy.} The Order to listen to the Qur'an After Allah mentioned that this Qur'an is a clear evidence, guidance and mercy for mankind, He commanded that one listen to the Qur'an when it is recited, in respect and honor of the Qur'an. This is to the contrary of the practice of the pagans of Quraysh, who said, 4m. 536 4"Listen not to this Qur'an, and make noise in the midst of its (recitation)" [41:26]. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Mas*ud said; "We would give Salams to each other during Salah. So the Ayah of Qur'an was revealed;

U&X \sj> fy} iWhen the Qur'an is recited, then listen to it.} j2 &.% ^ 4 ^jsj j*5> % .£*(* & iixj&k ij' ol ijg5cs^ ^ 4205. And remember your Lord within yourself, humbly and with fear and without loudness in words in the mornings and in the afternoons, and be not ofthose who are neglectful}. 4206. Surely, those who are with your Lord (angels) are never too proud to perform acts of worship to Him, but they glorify His praise and prostrate themselves before Him.} RememberingAllah in the Mornings and Afternoons Allah ordains that He be remembered more often in the mornings and the afternoons. Just as He ordered that He be worshipped during these two times when He said, 4's'Ar^ j2> j5 Qj -uij £Tr*j} 4And glorify the praises of your Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting.} [50:39] Before the night of Isra', when the five daily prayers were ordained, this Ayah was revealed in Makkah ordering that Allah be worshipped at these times, Allah said next, 4humbly and with fear} meaning, remember your Lord in secret, not loudly, with eagerness and fear. This is why Allah said next, jAj} 4and without loudness in words}. Therefore, it is recommended that remembering Allah in Dhikr is not performed in a loud voice. When the Companions asked the Messenger of Allah, "Is our Lord close, so that we call Him in secret, or far, so that we raise our voices?" Allah sent down the verse,

li' f'-i' -1 w 4And when My servants ask you concerning Me, then (answer them), 1 am indeed near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant iwhen he calls on Me (without any mediator or intercessor).} [2:186] m In the Two Sahibs, it is recorded that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari said, "The people raised their voices with Du'a' (invoking Allah) while travelling. The Prophet said to them. \$! iJli. i'j by-i N ijjL-iii Js. ^01 U> _ . , - >> • » i - f », > ,!{ v ; , , *' » • ; ^ ') , 4iP ' v4 . Ji J I -> J Aj «0 people! Take it easy on yourselves, for He Whom you are calling is not deaf or absent. Verily, He

Whom you are calling is the All-Hearer, close (by His knowledge), closer to one of you than the neck of his animal. n”*21 These texts encourage the servants to invoke Allah in Dhikr often, especially in the mornings and afternoons, so that they are not among those who neglect remembering Him. This is

why Allah praised the angels who praise Him night and day

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2120–2121]

without tiring, o* V Xf; o',4 i Surely, those who are with your Lord (i.e., angels) are never too proud to perform acts of worship to Him Allah reminded the servants of this fact so that they imitate the angels in their tireless worship and obedience of Allah. Prostration, here, upon the mention that the angels prostrate to Allah is legitimate. A Hadith reads; Liy^i tf;3 -lie- iwi2aj US dyhj “Why not you stand in line (for the prayer) like the angels stand in line before their Lord? They continue the first then the This narration is recorded by Ibn Abi HStim with a weak chain of narrators. There are other texts to support its meaning. 121 Fath Al-Bari6 : 157 and Muslim 4 :2077

next lines and they stand close to each other in This is the first place in the Qur’an where it has been legitimized - according to the agreement of the scholars - for the readers of the Qur’an, and those listening to its recitation, to perform prostration. 111 Muslim 1:322.

Surah 8: Al-Anfal

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2122]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Anfal (Chapter - 8)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2122–2129]

Al-Anfal is the eighth Surah of the Quran, revealed in Al-Madinah. It consists of 75 verses and 504 words. The word count of this Surah is one thousand, six hundred and thirty-four words and its letters number five thousand, two hundred and ninety-four. In the Name of Allah the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. They ask you about Al-Anfal (the spoils of war). Say: "Al-Anfal are for Allah and the Messenger." So have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you, and obey Allah and His Messenger, if you are believers. Meaning of Anfal Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Al-Anfal are the

spoils of war." Al-Bukhari also recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, "I said to Ibn 'Abbas, 'Surat Al-Anfat?' He said, It was revealed concerning (the battle of) Badr." Ah bin Abi Talhah reported, as Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas without a chain of narration, that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Al-Anfal are the spoils of war; they were for the Messenger of Allah and the believers, and none had a share in them." Similar was said by Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata', Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and several others. It was also said that the Nafl (singular for Anfal) refers to the portion of the spoils of war that the commander gives to some of the fighters after dividing the bulk of the spoils. It was also said that Anfal refers to the Khumus; one-fifth of the captured goods after four-fifths are divided [between the fighters]. It was also said that the Anfal refers to the Fay', the possessions taken from the disbelievers without fighting, and the animals, servants or whatever other possessions escape from the disbelievers to Muslims. Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Ali bin Salih bin Hay said: "It has reached me that, (They ask you about Al-Anfal) is about the divisions. This refers to what the Imam gives to some squads in addition to what is divided among the rest of the soldiers."

the battle of Badr. When the two armies met, Allah defeated the enemy and some of us pursued them inflicting utter defeat and casualties. Another group of us came to the battlefield collecting the spoils of war. Another group surrounded the Messenger of Allah, so that the enemy could not attack him suddenly. When it was night and the various army groups went back to our camp, some of those who

collected the spoils said, *We collected it, so none else will have a share in it.' Those who went in pursuit of the enemy said, *No, you have no more right to it than us. We kept the enemy away from the war spoils and defeated them.' Those who surrounded the Messenger of Allah 111 Ahmad 1:178. 121 Abu Dawud 3 :177, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:466, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :348 131 Ahmad 5 :322

254 Tafstr Ibn Kathir M to protect him said, *You have no more right to it than us, we surrounded the Messenger of Allah jgg for fear that the enemy might conduct a surprise attack against him, so we were busy.'The Ayah, 4(*^=*i* otj iThey ask you about Al-Anfdl (the spoils of war). Say: "Al- Anfdl are for Allah and the Messenger." So fear Allah and settle all matters of difference among you.} was revealed and the Messenger of Allah jg divided the Anfal equally between Muslims.'" '\$\$ J> jUl lij jg <i)l 'And Allah's Messenger would give a fourth for Anfal when there was a surprise attack in the land of the enemy, and when there was a confrontation then a third to the people who returned». The Prophet jg used to dislike the Anfal and encouraged strong fighters to give some of their share to weak Muslim fighters. At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah collected a similar narration for this Hadith, and At-Tirmidhi said, uHasan".m Allah said, olj 4l iSo have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you,} The Ayah commands, have Taqwa of Allah in all your affairs, settle matters of differences between you, do not wrong each other, do not dispute, and do not differ. Certainly, the guidance and knowledge that Allah has granted you is better than what you are disputing about [such as Al-Anfal\, £ at \fS\j} 4.and obey Allah and His Messenger,} in the division that the Messenger makes according to Allah's Ahmad 5:323. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :468 and Ibn Majah 2 :95 1

255 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (2 - 4) (Part-9 order. The Prophet ag only divided according to what Allah ordained, which is perfectly just and fair. Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, "This is a command from Allah and His Messenger jg to the believers, that they should have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of differences between them." A similar statement was reported from MujahidJ2 ' As-Suddi also commented on Allah's statement, o'i 'jid'-'ls iSo have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you}, meaning "Do not curse each other." 131 & tfty Jc& # '»l 2\$. f" •>! 1''-' 42 . 77ie believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Ayat are recited unto than, they increase their faith; and they put their trust in their Lord;} 43. Who perform the Salah and spend out of what We have provided them.} 44. It is they wlw are the believers in truth. For them are grades of dignity with their Lord, and forgiveness and a generous provision (Paradise).} Qualities of the Faithful and Truthful Believers 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about the Ayah, iThe believers are only tlwse who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts } "None of Allah's remembrance enters the hearts of the hypocrites upon performing what He has ordained. They At-Tabari 13:384. 121 At-Tabari 13:384. 131 At-Tabari 13:384.

neither believe in any of Allah's Ayat nor trust (in Allah) nor pray if they are alone nor pay the Zakdh due on their wealth. Allah stated that they are not believers. He then described the believers by saying, iij ft X> 4The believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and they perform what He has ordained, ifoi £*> jc# 0V0 4and when His Ayat are recited unto them, they increase their faith^ and conviction, iand they put their trust in their Lord}, having hope in none except Him." 111 Mujahid commented on, 4their hearts Wajilafy, "Their hearts become afraid and fearful."121 Similar was said by As-Suddi and several others. 131 The quality of a true believer is that when Allah is

mentioned, he feels a fear in his heart, and thus implements His orders and abstains from His prohibitions. Allah said in a similar Ayah, j-i*. o*) p-gjQ 'jy« Sit ()X* 'jiili jl i-lyui ijlSj X-> ^ ft 4And those who, when they have committed FdliishaJi (immoral sin) or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgiveness for their sins; - and none can forgive sins but Alldlt - and do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know^ [3:135], and, ^cfjUll^ <fX uf*J *A>j if* Uyy At-Tabari 13:386. At-Tabari 13:386. 131 At-Tabari 13:386.

257Surah 8 . Al-Anfdl (2 - 4) (Part-9) iBut as for him who feared standing before his Lord, and restrained himself from vain desires. Verily, Paradise will be his abode.\$ (79:40-41] Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that As-Suddi commented, <!>&\$ 'C\} iThe believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts> “A man might be thinking of committing injustice or a sin. But he abstains when he is told, ‘Have Taqwa of Allah’, and his heart becomes fearful.” Faith increases when the Qur'an is recited Allah's statement. 4^4 A'* ^ iAnd when His Aydt are recited unto them, they increase their faith;} is similar to His statement, ijiJ. & 1^1 Jjij ,»4~* Vui* U whatever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say: “Which of you has had his faith increased by it?” As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice} [9:124]. Al-Bukhari and other scholars relied on this Ayah (8:2) and those similar, as evidence that faith increases and varies in strength from heart to heart. This is also the view of the majority of the scholars of Islam, prompting some scholars, such as Ash-Shafil, Ahmad bin Hanbal and Abu 'Ubayd to declare that this is the consensus of the Ummah, as we mentioned in the beginning of the explanation of Sahih. Al- Bukhari. All the thanks and praises are due to Allah. The Reality of Tawakkul Allah said,

}And they put their trust in their Lord.} Therefore, the believers hope in none except Allah, direct their dedication to Him alone, seek refuge with Him alone, invoke Him alone for their various needs and supplicate to Him alone. They know that whatever He wills, occurs and that whatever He does not will never occurs, that He alone is the One Who has the decision in His kingdom, without partners; none can avert the decision of Allah and He is swift in reckoning. Hence the statement of SaTd bin Jubayr, “Tawakkul of Allah is the essence of faith.” Deeds of Faithful Believers Allah said next, -t. * •« li iWho perform the Saldh and spend out of what We have provided them.} Allah describes the actions of the believers after He mentioned their faith. The acts mentioned here include all types of righteous acts, such as establishing prayer, which is Allah's right. Qatadah said, “Establishing the prayer requires preserving its times, making ablution for it, bowing down and prostrating.” (1 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan said, “Establishing the prayer means to preserve its times, perform perfect purity for it, perform perfect bowings and prostrations, recite the Qur'an during it, sitting for Tashahhud and reciting the Saldh (invoking Allah's blessings) for the benefit of the Prophet.”*2' Spending from what Allah has granted includes giving the Zakah and the rest of the what is due from the servant, either

what is obligatory or recommended. All of the servants are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2129–2152]

Allah's dependents, and the most beloved among them to Him are the most beneficial to His creation. The Reality of Faith Allah's statement, Ibn Abi Hatim 1:37. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:37.

«Residents of Paradise see the residents of the highest grades just as you see the distant planet in the horizon of the sky. Verily, Abu Bakr and 'Umar are among them (in the highest grades), and how excellent they are. d j Si St ££ u\$> iit^ ^ £3?® £jt J»J' 4*: J 4i\ ijij oli j« J ayj pS-S ^ 4:£;^ •/£MJ&^ : £:£^#gs 45. As your Lord caused you to go out from your home with the truth; and verily, a party among the believers disliked it.} 46 . Disputing with you concerning the truth after it was made manifest, as if they were being driven to death, while they were looking (at it).} 47. And (remember) when Allah promised you (Muslims) one of the two parties, that it should be yours ; you wished that the one not armed should be yours, but Allah willed to justify the truth by His Words and to cut off the roots of the disbelievers.} 48. That He might cause the truth to triumph and bring falsehood to nothing, even though the criminals hate it.} Following the Messenger^ is Better for the Believers Allah said, 4&& 'T} 4As your Lord caused you to go out...} After Allah described the believers as fearing their Lord, resolving matters of dispute between themselves and obeying Allah and His Messenger He then said here, “since you disputed about dividing war spoils and differed with each other about them, Allah took them away from you. He and His Messenger then divided them in truth and justice, thus ensuring continued benefit for all of you. Similarly, you disliked meeting the armed enemy in battle, 111 Ahmad 2:27, Abu Dfiwud 4 :287 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :142 and Ibn Majah 1 :37.

261 Surah 8 . Al-Anfal (5 - 8) (Part-9) who marched in support of their religion and to protect their caravan. You disliked fighting, so Allah decided that battle should occur and made you meet your enemy, without planning to do so on your part.’ This incident carried guidance, light, victory and triumph. Allah said; \ zpzJ%£ £2 p#% \$£\$ ^ 4™ < lit; tis ?2 X £2 4Jihad is ordained for you though you dislike it, and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you, and that you like a thing which is bad for you. Allah knows but you do not know.} (2:216) As-Suddi commented, 4, • Sop"" oi lAj} 4And verily, a party among the believers disliked} to meet [the armed] idolators.” 4% 4 4Disputing with you concerning the truth after it was made manifest,} Some have commented, “(Allah says:) they ask and argue with you about Al-Anfal just as they argued with you when you went out for the battle of Badr, saying, “You marched with us to confiscate the caravan. You did not inform us that there will be fighting and that we should prepare for it.” 4-t^i U- J® 4but Allah willed to justify the truth by His Words} Allah says, ‘He willed for you to meet the armed enemy [rather than the caravan] so that He makes you prevail above them and gain victory over them, making His religion apparent and Islam victorious and dominant above all religions. He has perfect knowledge of the consequences of all things, you are surrounded by His wise planning, although people only like what appears favorable to them,’ J “/r- &2 !»*£2 J fr-c-jp JVilt C^f} ip

262 Tafstr Ibn Kafhir ijihad (fighting in Allah's cause) is ordained for you (Muslims) though you dislike it, and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you and that you like a thing which is bad for you > [2:216]. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas said, “When the Messenger of Allah ^ heard that Abu Sufyan had left the Sham area (headed towards Makkah with Quraysh’s caravan), he encouraged the Muslims to march forth to intercept them, saying. » Lit jf 4)1 Jil I lj_j ‘j£ oji iThis is the caravan of Quraysh carrying their property, so march forth to intercept it, Allah might make it as war spoils for you.D The people started mobilizing Muslims, although some of them did not mobilize, thinking that the Prophet 5g\$ would not have to fight. Abu Sufyan was cautiously gathering information on the latest news spying on travelers he met, out of fear for the caravan, especially upon

entering the area of Hijaz (Western Arabia). Some travelers told him that Muhammad had mobilized his companions for his caravan. He was anxious and hired Damdam bin 'Amr Al-Ghifari to go to Makkah and mobilize the Quraysh to protect their caravan, informing them that Muhammad jg had mobilized his Companions to intercept the caravan. Damdam bin 'Amr went in a hurry to Makkah. Meanwhile, the Messenger of Allah jg marched with his companions until he reached a valley called Dhafirān. When he left the valley, he camped and was informed that the Quraysh had marched to protect their caravan. The Messenger of Allah consulted the people for advice and conveyed the news about Quraysh to them. Abu Bakr stood up and said something good, and so did 'Umar. Al-Miqdad bin 'Amr stood up and said, 'O Allah's Messenger! March to what Allah has commanded you, for we are with you. By Allah! We will not say to you what the Children of Israel said to Musa, i" So go you and your Lord and fight you two, we are sitting right here" ^ [5:24].

263 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (5 - 8) (Part-9) Rather, go you and Your Lord and fight, we will be fighting along with you both. By He Who has sent you with Truth! If you decide to take us to Birk-ul-Ghimad, we will fight along with you until you reach it.' The Messenger of Allah said good words to Al-Miqdad and invoked Allah for his benefit. The Messenger of Allah again said. t Give me your opinion, O people wanting to hear from the Ansar. This is because the majority of the people with him then were the Ansar. When the Ansar gave the Prophet Sg their pledge of obedience at Al-'Aqabah, they proclaimed, 'O Allah's Messenger! We are not bound by this pledge unless, and until, you arrive in our land. When you have arrived in our area, you are under our protection, and we shall protect you in the same manner we protect our children and wives.' The Messenger of Allah sg feared that the Ansar might think that they are not obliged to support him except from his enemies who attack Al-Madinah, not to march with him to an enemy in other areas. When the Prophet said this, Sa'd bin Mu'adh asked him, 'O Allah's Messenger! Is it us whom you meant?' The Prophet answered in the positive. Sa'd said, "We have faith and believed in you, testified that what you brought is the truth, and gave you our pledges and promises of allegiance and obedience. Therefore, march, O Allah's Messenger, for what Allah has commanded you. Verily, by He Who has sent you in Truth, if you decided to cross this sea (the Red Sea), we will follow you in it, and none among us would stay behind. We do not dislike that we meet our enemy tomorrow. Verily, we are patient in war, fierce in battle. May Allah make you witness what makes your eyes pleased with us. Therefore, march with us with the blessing of Allah.' The Messenger of Allah was pleased with what Sa'd said and was encouraged by it. He proclaimed, f t l J & ' j S > l j 2 * 1 V ^ j 2 * 1 2 > ; J U f > J s \$ \$ • March with the blessing of Allah and receive the good news. For Allah has indeed promised me one of the two camps (confiscating the caravan or defeating the Quraysh army). By Alldh! It is as if I am

265 Surah 8. Al-Anffl (9 - 10) (Part-9) i (Retnember) when you sought help of your Lord and He answered you \$ until, 4 * < y f # & & i then verily, Allah is severe in punishment that Ibn Mas*ud said, "I was a witness to something that Al-Miqdad bin Al-Aswad did, that I would like more than almost anything else to have been the one who did it. Al-Miqdad came to the Prophet while he was invoking Allah against the idolators and proclaimed, * We will not say as the people of Musa said, "So go you and your Lord and fight you two." Rather, we will fight to your right, to your left, before you and behind you.' I saw the Prophet's face beaming with pleasure because of what Al-Miqdad said to him." * Al-Bukhan next narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that on the day of Badr, the Prophet said, j U « £ . L i ! ^ 4 J L 3 i

ill** iliiii «O Allah! I invoke You for Your covenant and promise (victory). O Allah! If You decide so (cause our defeat), You will not be worshipped. Abu Bakr held the Prophet's hand and said, Prophet jg went out proclaiming, .fe cr^ "Enough." The «Their multitude will be put to flight, and they will show their backs. An-Nasa'i also collected this Hadith.*2 * Allah's statement, iwith a thousand of the angels Murdifi^ means, they follow each other in succession, according to Harun bin Hubayrah who narrated this from Ibn 'Abbas about, 111 FathAl-Bdri 7 :335. * Fath Al-Bari 7 :335 and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :477

266 Tafstr Ibt Kathir 4Murdifi\$y\ meaning each behind the other in succession. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah Al-Walibi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah supported His Prophet ig and the believers with a thousand angels, five hundred under the leadership of Jibril on one side and five hundred under the leadership of Mtkah on another side." 121 Imams Abu Jalar bin Jarir At-Tabari and Muslim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said¹³¹ that 'Umar said, "While a Muslim man was pursuing an idolator (during the battle of Badr), he heard the sound of a whip above him and a rider saying, 'Come, O Hayzum!' Then he looked at the idolator, who fell to the ground. When he investigated, he found that the idolator's nose had wound and his face torn apart, just as if he received a strike from a whip on it, and the entire face had turned green. The Ansari man came to the Messenger of Allah M and told him what had happened and the Messenger ?g replied, lyuji ,uiJi ai; i* ius «Yom have said the truth, that was from the reinforcements from the third heaven .» The Muslims killed seventy (pagans) in that battle and captured another seventy. ^4| Al-Bukhari also wrote a chapter in his SatiLih. about the participation of the angels in Badr. He collected a Hadith from Rifali bin Rfifi 'Az-Zuraqi, who participated in Badr, Jibril came to the Prophet sg and asked him, "How honored are those who participated in Badr among you?" The Prophet jg said. «Among the best Muslims . » Jibril said, "This is the case with the angels who participated in Badr." ¹⁵¹ Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith. At-Tabarani also collected it in Al-Mu'jam Al-Kabir, but from Rafi' bin Khadij, which is an apparent mistake. The correct narration is from Rifali, as Al-Bukhari recorded it. In At-Tabari 13:412. At-Tabari 13:423. [3] At-Tabari 13:409 and Mustim 3:1383. Muslim 3:1384. ¹⁵¹ FathAl-B&ri 7:362.

267 Surah 8. Al-Anffi (9 - 10) (Part-91 the Two SahSis, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah ig said to 'Umar, when Umar suggested that the Prophet have Hatib bin Abi Balta'ah executed, U :Jiii jjb jit £J1»I Ji 2) J*t •4-i •He [Hatib] participated in Badr. How do you know that Allah has not looked at the people of Badr and vroclaimed, 'Do whatever you want, for I have forgiven you .' »' 1 Allah said next, 4Allah made it only as glad tidings... Allah made sending down the angels and informing you this fact as glad tidings, of iand that your hearts be at rest therewith. Surely, Allah is able to give you (O Muslims) victory over your enemies, and victory only comes from Him, without need to send the angels, 4And there is no victory except from Allah. Allah said in another Ayah, sC* JU> £|i jCjj' !jli 'j) CJJ& \ij& OjjJ' j iji ouljj jffci j£Sj iai lUi jji lijlyt si/ii 2# (hMw &-8> pp^tr- 4So, when you meet (in fight in Allah's cause) those who disbelieve, smite (their) necks till when you have killed and wounded many of them, then bind a bond firtnly (on them, take them as captives). Thereafter (is the time) either for generosity (free them without ransom), or ransom (according to what benefits Islam), until war lays down its burden. Thus, but if it had been Allah's will, He Himself could certainly have punished I1 ' FathAl-Bari 7 :355 and Muslim 4 :194 1

268 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some of you with others. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost. He will guide them and set right their state. And admit them to Paradise which He has made known to them.} [il] [47:4-6] and, *% \pxoM# &^2 j:eV>&& if 44 iAnd so are the days (good and not so good), that We give to men by turns, that Allah may test those who believe, and that He may take martyrs from among you . And Allah likes not the wrongdoers. And that Allah may test (or purify) the believers (from sins) and destroy the disbelievers. [3:140-141] These are points of wisdom for which Allah has legislated performing Jihad, by the hands of the believers against the disbelievers. Allah used to destroy the previous nations that denied the Prophets, using various disasters that encompassed these rebellious nations. For instance, Allah destroyed the people of Nūh with the flood, 'Ad with the wind, Thamūd with the scream, the people of Lūṭ with an earthquake and the people of Shu'ayb by the Day of the Shadow. After Allah sent Mūsā and destroyed his enemy Fir'aun and his soldiers by drowning, He sent down the Tawrah to him in which He legislated fighting against the disbelievers, and this legislation remained in the successive Laws. Allah said, i *\$' t PCk 4-^=4' Pf £& P&& iAnd indeed We gave Mūsā - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment.} [28:43] It is more humiliating for the disbeliever and more comforting to the hearts of the faithful that the believers kill the disbelievers by their own hands. Allah said to the believers of this Ummah, i'&SPUP fp JJp jLpJ 'fsp> ail P+jPu That is , they will recognize their places , as they did in the worldly life

269 Surah 8. Al-Anfāl (9 - 10) (Part-9) iFight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them, and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of a believing people. \$[9: 14] This is why killing the disbelievers of Quraysh by the hand of their enemies, whom they used to despise, was more humiliating to the disbelievers and comforting to the hearts of the party of faith. Abū Jahl, for instance, was killed in battle and this was more humiliating for him than dying in his bed, or from lightning, wind, or similar afflictions. Also, Abū Lahab died from a terrible disease [that caused him to stink] and none of his relatives could bear approaching him. They had to wash him with water by sprinkling it from a distance, then threw stones over his corpse, until it was buried under them! Allah said next, iVerily, Allah is All-Mighty the might is His, His Messengers and the believers, both in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said in another Ayah, f>: }yj 4p: OijpB 4We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe, in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth (Day of Resurrection).^[40:51] Allah said next, iAll-Wise . in that He legislated fighting the disbeliever, even though He is able to destroy them and bring their demise by His will and power, all praise and honor is due to Him. P pij # \$3 & il; lil PP VPPS 4Sp <SP ii' AV')) j*ri VP) p*. srphPj 'jjjj ill. (Remember) when He covered you with a slumber as a security from Him, and He caused water (rain) to descend on

y _ Tafsir Ibtī Kathir you from the sky, to clean you thereby and to remove from you the Rijz (whispering or dirt) of Shayṭān, and to strengthen your hearts, and make your faith firm thereby.} 412 . (Remember) when your Lord revealed to the angels, "Verily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed. I will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved, so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes."} 413. This is because they defied and disobeyed Allah and His Messenger. And whoever defies and disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, Allah is severe in punishment.} 414. This is (the torment), so taste it; and surely, for the disbelievers is the

torment of the Fire.) Slumber overcomes Muslims Allah reminds the believers of the slumber that He sent down on them as security from the fear they suffered from, because of the multitude of their enemy and the sparseness of their forces. They were given the same favor during the battle of Uhud, which Allah described, c4?iXLU&&'&&\$} 4Then after the distress, He sent down security for you. Slumber overtook a party of you, while another party was thinking about themselves. } [3 :154] Abu Talhah said, "I was among those who were overcome by slumber during (the battle of) Uhud. The sword fell from my hand several times, and I kept picking it up again, several times. I also saw the Companions' heads nodding while in the rear guard." Al-Hafiz Abu Yala narrated that 'Ali said, "Only Al-Miqdad had a horse during Badr, and at some point, I found that all of us fell asleep, except the Messenger of Allah 0&- He was praying under a tree and crying until dawn." 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "Slumber during battle is security from Allah, but during prayer, it is from Shaytan."*2 * Qatadah said, "Slumber affects the head, while sleep affects the *J * Musnad Abu Yala 1 :242. * At-Tabari 13:419.

271 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (11 - 14) (Part-9) heart." Slumber overcame the believers on the day of Uhud, and this incident is very well-known. As for this Ayah (8:11), it is describing the battle of Badr, indicating that slumber also overcame the believers during Badr. Therefore, it appears that this will occur for the believers, whenever they are in distress, so that their hearts feel safe and sure of Allah's aid, rewards, favor and mercy from Allah with them. Allah said in another Ayah, c ^ C ^ i Verily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief.} (94:5-6) In the Sahih, it is recorded that on the day of Badr, while he was in the bunker with Abu Bakr, the Messenger j j § and Abu Bakr were invoking Allah. Suddenly, slumber overcame the Messenger and he woke up smiling and declared, i "Good news, O Abu Bakr! This is Jibril with dust on his shoulders. "» He left the shade while reciting Allah's statement, i Their multitude will be put to flight, and they will show their backs.} [54:45]*2 Rain fall** on the Eve of Badr Allah said next, i and He caused rain to descend on you from the sky.} 'Ali bin Abi Jahah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the Prophet arrived at Badr, he made camp. At the time, there was a sandy piece of land between the idolaters and the water (the wells at Badr). Muslims felt weak and the Shaytan cast *** Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1664. ' Fath Al-Bari 7 :364

frustration into their hearts. He whispered to them, 'You claim that you are Allah's supporters and that His Messenger is among you! However, the idolaters have taken over the water resource from you, while you pray needing purity.' Allah sent down heavy rain, allowing the Muslims to drink and use it for purity. Allah also removed Shaytan's whisper and made the sand firm when rain fell on it, and the Muslims walked on the sand along with their animals, until they reached the enemy. Allah supported His Prophet and the believers with a thousand angels on one side, five hundred under the command of Jibril and another five hundred under the command of Mikail on another side."* 11 An even a better narration is that collected by Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, author of Al-Maghazi, may Allah have mercy upon him. Ibn Ishaq narrated that, Yazid bin Ruwman narrated to him that, Thawab bin Az-Zubayr said, "Allah sent rain down from the sky on a sandy valley. That rain made the area where the Messenger of Allah j g and his Companions camped firmer so that it did not hinder their movement. Meanwhile, the part that the Quraysh were camping on became difficult to move in." Mujahid said, "Allah sent down the rain on the believers before slumber overtook them, and the rain settled the dust, made the ground firmer, made them feel at ease and their feet firmer."*31 Allah said next, i to clean you thereby} using it after answering the call of nature or needing to wash oneself, and this involves

cleansing what is on the outside. } and to remove from you the Rijz of Shaytan, } such as his whispers and evil thoughts, this involves sinner purification, whereas Allah's statement about the residents of Paradise, 1,1 At-Tabari 13:423. Al-Waqidi in Al-Maghazi 1 :54 At-Tabari 13:425.

273 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (11 - 14) (Part-9) i Their garments will be of fine green silk, and gold embroidery. They will be adorned with bracelets of silver } [76:21] involves outer appearance, i ££# i and their Lord will give them a pure drink. } [76:21] that purifies the anger, envy and hatred that they might have felt. This is the inner purity. Next, Allah said, i and to strengthen your hearts, } with patience and to encourage you to fight the enemies, and this is inner courage, i and make your feet firm thereby }, this involves outer courage. Allah knows best. Allah commands the Angels to fight and support the Believers Allah said next, i [X \$2 \$ X u-y. i (Remember) when your Lord revealed to the angels, "Verily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed." } This is a hidden favor that Allah has made known to the believers, so that they thank Him and are grateful to Him for it. Allah, glorified, exalted, blessed and praised be He, has revealed to the angels -whom He sent to support His Prophet, religion and believing group - to make the believers firmer. Allah's statement, i [js\ffZ ±&. } i l will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved. } means, "you - angels - support the believers, strengthen their (battle) front against their enemies, thus, implementing My command to you. I will cast fear, disgrace and humiliation over those who defied My command and denied My Messenger,

i p fe* pi ac'M& \sp& } i so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes, } strike them on their foreheads to tear them apart and over the necks to cut them off, and cut off their limbs, hands and feet. It was said that, i over the necks refers to striking the forehead, or the neck, according to Ad-Dahhak and 'Atiyyah Al-'Awfi. In support of the latter, Allah commanded the believers, *•>J>'V-Mel (il& Pfi \tP 'P} 4 So, when you meet (in fight Jihad in Allah's cause) those who disbelieve, smite (their) necks till when you have killed and wounded many of them, then bind a bond firmly (on them, take them as captives). } [47:4] Ar-Rabi bin Anas said, "In the aftermath of Badr, the people used to recognize whomever the angels killed from those whom they killed, by the wounds over their necks, fingers and toes, because those parts had a mark as if they were branded by fire." Allah said, i p p i and smite over all their fingers and toes. } Ibn Jarir commented that this Ayah commands, "O believers! Strike every limb and finger on the hands and feet of your (disbelieving) enemies." Al-'Awfi reported, that Ibn 'Abbas said about the battle of Badr that Abu Jahl said, "Do not kill them (the Muslims), but capture them so that you make known to them what they did, their ridiculing your religion and shunning Al-Lat and Al-'Uzza (two idols)." Allah then sent down to the angels, S \p: oJ' \p& \$ } i p. pi 4^*^' (1) At-Tabari 13:431.

275 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (14 - 16) (Part-9) i Verily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed. I will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved, so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes. } In that battle, Abu Jahl (may Allah curse him) was killed along with sixty-nine men. Tj Qbah bin Abu Mua'it was captured and then killed, thus bring the death toll of the pagans to seventy, i This is because they defied and disobeyed Allah and His Messenger. } joining the camp that defied Allah and His Messenger si not including themselves in the camp of Allah's Law and faith in Him. Allah said, jo— <£> } i And whoever defies and disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, Allah is severe in punishment. } for He will crush whoever defies and disobeys Him. Nothing

ever escapes Allah's grasp nor can anything ever stand against His anger. Blessed and exalted He is, there is no true deity or Lord except Him. {This is (the torment), so taste it; and surely, for the disbelievers is the torment of the Fire.} This Ayah addresses the disbeliever, saying, taste this torment and punishment in this life and know that the torment of the Fire in the Hereafter is for the disbelievers. 'J4 q \p: 04} r4<- 415 . O you who believe! When you meet those who disbelieve, in a battlefield, never turn your backs to them.} 416. And whoever turns his back to them on such a day - unless it be a stratagem of war, or to retreat to a troop (of his

own) - he indeed has drawn upon himself wrath from Allah. And his abode is Hell, and worst indeed is that destination!} Fleeing from Battle is prohibited, and its Punishment Allah said, while warning against fleeing from the battlefield and threatening those who do it with the Fire, <63 'j# Zi 6, rpn y; 40 you who believe! When you meet those who disbelieve, in a battlefield,} when you get near the enemy and march towards them, inever turn your backs to them . do not run away from battle and leave your fellow Muslims behind, 4J&i \ iAnd whoever turns his back to them on such a day - unless it be a stratagem ofwar . . The Ayah says, whoever flees from the enemy by way of planning to pretend that he is afraid of the enemy, so that they follow him and he takes the chance and returns to kill the enemy, then there is no sin on him. This is the explanation of Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi.111 Ad-Dahhak also commented, "Whoever went ahead of his fellow Muslims to investigate the strength of the enemy and make use of it, 4or to retreat to a troop (of his own)}, meaning he leaves from here to another troop of Muslims to assist them or be assisted by them. So that is allowed for him, or even during the battle if he flees from his brigade to the commander. Or going to the grand Imam, would also fall under this permission." Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, said about Abu Ubayd when he was fighting on the bridge in the land of the Persians, because of the many Zoroastrian soldiers, "If he retreated to me then I would be as a troop for him." This is how it was reported by Muhammad bin Sirin from m At-Tabari 13:436-437.

't 'Umar. In the report of Abu Tlthman An-Nahdi from 'Umar, he said: When Abu TJbayd was fighting, 'Umar said, "O people! We are your troop." Mujahid said that 'Umar said, "We are the troop of every Muslim." Abdul-Malik bin 'Umayr reported from "Umar, "O people! Don't be confused over this Ayah, it was only about the day of Badr, and we are a troop for every Muslim." Ibn Abi Hatim [recorded] that Nafi' questioned Ibn 'Umar, "We are people who are not stationary when fighting our enemy, and we may not know where our troop is, be it that of our Imam or our army." So he replied, "The troop is Allah's Messenger jg." I said but Allah said, iwheti you meet those who disbelieve in the battlefield^ to the end of the Ayah . So he said; "This Ayah was about Badr, not before it nor after it." Ad-Dahhak commented that Allah's statement, 3i for to retreat to a troop}, refers to "Those who retreat to the Messenger of Allah \$g and his Companions (when the Messenger jg was alive), and those who retreat in the present time to his commander or companions." ,2 * However, if one flees for any other reason than those mentioned here, then it is prohibited and considered a major sin. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah m said, •i"Shun the seven great destructive sins."» The people inquired, "O Allah's Messenger! What are they?" He said, U jSvj |£>I jsvj lil J\ ^li\ jlij iL h-jhu aO I oI'-ahJI ijij * V; l j ^ ^l At-Tabari 13:436. 121 At-Tabari 13:437.

in Tafsir Ibn Kathir *(They are:) Joining others in worship with Allah, magic taking life which Allah has forbidden, except for a just cause (according to Islamic law), consuming Riba, consuming an orphan's wealth, fleeing the battlefield at the time of fighting, and false accusation to chaste women, who never even think of anything touching chastity and are good believers. This is why Allah said here, {he indeed has drawn upon himself...}, and returned with wrath from Allah. And his abode...}, destination, and dwelling place on the Day of Return, nr UESiK ^ gCMps~3iJZ'&£2dl<ttl dirfjil *} »'yj 4is He//, and worst indeed is that destination!} & # h a <#;^ jT i*; ai^^ if ^ at fes. t* iA detf® i^TK 417. You killed them not, but Allah killed them. And you threw not when you did throw, but Allah threw, that He might test the believers by a fair trial from Him. Verily, Allah is All- *** Fath Al-Bari 5 :462 and Muslim 1 :92

invoked Allah humbly and expressing his neediness before Allah. He then threw a handful of sand at the disbelievers and said, •Humiliated be their faces.* He then commanded his Companions to start fighting with sincerity and they did. Allah made this handful of sand enter the eyes of the idolaters, each one of them were struck by some of it and it distracted them making each of them busy. Allah said, itSj S»T £j} iAnd you threw not when you did throw, but Allah threw.} Therefore, it is Allah Who made the sand reach their eyes and busied them with it, not you (O Muhammad) sg. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Muhammad bin JaTar bin Az-Zubayr narrated to him that TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr said about Allah's statement, 4^ yf. A'M 'i'- ithat He might test the believers by a fair trial from Him.} "So that the believers know Allah's favor for them by giving them victory over their enemy, even though their enemy was numerous, while they were few. They should thus know His right and express gratitude for His favor on them." Similar was said by Ibn Jarir. It is stated in a Hadith, oEvery trail (from Allah) is a favor for ms.» [2] Allah said next, 4(£ £5" ^ iVerily, Allah is All-Hearer, Ali-Knower.} Allah hears the supplication and knows those who deserve help and triumph. Allah said, i-T off <>f '(££} At-Tabari 13:448. A similar Hadith is recorded by Muslim no . 6900

281Siirah 8. Al-Anfdl (19) (Part-9 iThis (is the fact) and surely Allah weakens the deceitful plots of the disbelievers.} This is more good news, aside from the victory that the believers gained. Allah informed them that He will weaken the plots of the disbelievers in the future, degrade them and make everything they have perish and be destroyed, all praise and thanks are due to Allah. \$ j;& \az oi; ^ il9. (O disbelievers) if you ask for a judgement, noio has the judgement come unto you; and if you cease (to do wrong), it ivill be better for you, and if you return (to the attack), so shall We return, and your forces will be of no avail to you, however numerous they be; and verily, Allah is with the believers.} The Response to the Disbelievers Who ask for a Judgement Allah says to the disbeliever, li o[} ilf you ask for a judgement}, you invoked Allah for victoiy, judgement and a decision between you and your believing nemesis, and you got what you asked for. Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others reported from Az-Zuhri from 'Abdullah bin Tha'labah bin Su'ayr who said that Abu Jahl said on the day of Badr, "O Allah! Whichever of the two camps {pagans and Muslims) severed the relation of the womb and brought us

what is not familiar, then destroy him this day." This Ayah was

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2152–2212]

later on revealed, 3i JSi ilfy you ask for a judgement, then now has the judgement come unto you,} until the end of the Ayah) Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Thalabah said, “Abu Jahl asked for (Allah’s judgment) when he said upon facing the Muslims, ‘O Allah! m At-Tabari 13:453.

Those among us who severed the relations of the womb and brought forth what we do not recognize, then destroy him this day.’” * xhis was also recorded by An-Nasa’i in the Book of Tafsir (of his Sunan) and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak, and he said, “It is Sahih according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs, and they did not record it.”.*2 * Similar statements were reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Yazld bin Ruwman and several others. As-Suddi commented, “Before the idolaters left Makkah for Badr, they clung to the curtains covering the Ka*bah and supplicated to Allah for victoiy, ‘O Allah! Give victory to the exalted among the two armies, the most honored among the two groups, and the most righteous among the two tribes.’ Allah revealed the Ayah, ilfy you ask for a judgement, then now has the judgement come unto you.} Allah says here, 1 accepted your supplication and Muhammad gained the victory.” ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said; “This is Allah the Most High’s answer to their supplication; jHJ iAnd (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this is indeed the truthfrom you..y' [8:32] Allah said next. 4and if you cease... from your disbelief and rejection of Allah and His Messenger^ i^%^} iit will be better for you}, in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, &V£o0 |l * Ahmad 5:531 * An-Nasa’i in Al-Kubrd 6 :350 and Al-Hakim 2 :328 At-Jabari 13:453.

283 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (20 - 23) (Part-9) iand if you return, so shall We return... This is similar to another Ayah, ibut if you return (to sins), We shall return (to Our punishment).} (17:8] meaning, *if you persist in your disbelief and misguidance, We shall repeat the defeat that you suffered,’ iand your forces will be of no avail to you, however numerous they be...} for even ifyou gather whatever forces you can, then know that those whom Allah is with cannot be defeated, \$ji} iand verily, Allah is with the believers.} in reference to the Prophet’s group, the side of the chosen Messenger jg. m 2b&& % feZ St i&J *u\ if i* oftif ® & e&S & fc fe 'if # % 'i 120. O you who believe! Obey Allah and His Messenger, and turn not awayfrom him while you are hearing.} 121. And be not like those who say: "We have heard," but they hear not.} 422. Verily, the worst of living creatures with Allah are the deafand the dumb (the disbelievers), who understand not.} 423. Had Allah known ofany good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even ifHe had made them listen, they would but have turned away with aversion.} TheCommand to obeyAllah and His Messenger^ Allah commands His believing servants to obey Him and His Messenger 3g and warns them against defying him and

284 Tafsir lbtt Katlur imitating the disbelievers who reject him. Allah said, iand turn not away from him...}, neither refrain from obeying him or following his commands nor indulge in what he forbade, iwhile you are hearing.} after you gained knowledge of his Message, iAnd be not like those who say: "We have heard," but tlwy hear not.} Ibn Ishaq said that this Ayah refers to the hypocrites, who pretend to hear and obey, while in fact they do neither. 111 Allah declares that these are the most wicked creatures among the Children of Adam, iVerily, the worst of living creatures with Allah are the deaf} who do not hear the truth. iand the dumb} who cannot comprehend it, iioho understand not.} These indeed are the most wicked creatures, for eveiy creature except them abide by the way that Allah created in them. These people were created to worship Allah, but instead disbelieved. This is why Allah equated them to animals, when He said, i'faj j ££ ij>£=> jd\ iAnd the example of those who disbelieve

is as that of him who shouts to those that hear nothing but calls and cries.} [2:171], and, £4\$ fa?£git m At-Tabari 13 :458

285 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (23 - 24) (Part-9) ijhey are like cattle, nay even more astray ; those! They are the heedless ones.} [7:179] It was also said that the Ayah (8:22) refers to some of the pagans of Quraysh from the tribe of Bani ‘Abd Ad-Dar, according to Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Ibn Jarir. 1 11 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that this Ayah refers to hypocrites, as we stated. There is no contradiction here, because both disbelievers and hypocrites are devoid of sound comprehension, in addition to having lost the intention to do good. Allah states here that such are those who neither have sound understanding nor good intentions, even if they have some type of reason, l iil' p 'jj} 4 Had Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen.} He would have helped them understand. However, this did not happen because there is no goodness in such people, for Allah knows that, ieven if He had made them listen...} and allowed them to understand, ithey would but have turned...}, intentionally and out of stubbornness, even after they comprehend, iwith aversion.}, to the truth. &\$& k q 4 \p: l&> & •*£ P' 424. O you who believe! Answer Allah and (His) Messenger wheti he (the Messenger) calls you to that which will give you life, and know that Allah comes between a person and his heart. And verily to Him you shall (all) be gathered.} (M At-Tabari 13:460.

286 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Command to answer and obey Allah and His Messenger jg Al-Bukhfiri said, "^(Answer), obey, Q) ithat which will give you life> that which will make your affairs good." Al-Bukhari went on to narrate that Abu Said bin Al- Mu'alla said, "I was praying when the Prophet jg passed by and called me, but I did not answer him until I finished the prayer. He said, :iiJl Jju S'jZfc jf kiUli U» *What prevented you from answering me? Has not Allah said: a lit k w 40 you who believe! Answer Allah and (His) Messenger when he calls you to that which will give you life)?' He then said: ^ Jt ;5>-' "Z will teach you the greatest Surah in the Qur'an before I leave. When he was about to leave, I mentioned what he said to me. He said. iAll the praises and thanks are to Allah, the Lord of all that exists...) [1:1-6]. tSurely, it is the seven oft-repeated verses.*" ^ Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Muhammad bin Jafar bin Az-Zubayr said that "Urwah bin Az-Zubayr explained this Ayah, Q lit&%£ ip: <4\vk) 1,1 Fath Al-B&ri 8:158.

287 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (24) (Part-9) 40 you who believe! Answer Allah and (His) Messenger when he calls you to that which will give you life, ^ "Answer when called to war (Jihad) with which Allah gives you might after meekness, and strength after weakness, and shields you from the enemy who oppressed you." [1 Allah comes in between a Person and His Heart Allah said, 4.*£ ^& at& £Ujt» iand know that Allah comes in between a person and his hearty Ibn ‘Abbas commented, "Allah prevents the believer from disbelief and the disbeliever from faith." ,2) Al-Hakim recorded this in his Mustadrak and said, "It is Sahih and they did not record it." . ' Similar was said by Mujahid, Said, ‘Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih ‘Atiyyah, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As- Suddi.[41 In another report from Mujahid, he commented; 4 ...comes in between a person and his heart. "Leaves him without comprehension," As-Suddi said, "Prevents one self from his own heart, so he will neither believe nor disbelieve except by His leave." There are several Hadiths that conform with the meaning of this Ayah. For instance, Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, "The Prophet jg used to often say these words, @ilho c.j s^JLaa U@ «0 You Who changes the hearts, make my heart firm on Your religion .» We said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger!

We believed in you and in what you brought us. Are you afraid for us?' He said, Irt Jr*rM Irk l f-" Sirah IbnHisham 2 :324 At-Tabari 13:468. 131 Al-yakim 2 :328. 141 At-Tabari 13:470-471.

289 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (25) (Part-9) Therefore, such Fitnah will not be restricted to the sinners and evildoers. Rather, it will reach the others if the sins are not stopped and prevented. Imam Ahmad recorded that Mutarrif said, "We asked Az-Zubayr, 'O Abu 'Abdullah! What brought you here (for the battle of Al-Jamal)? You abandoned the Khalfah who was assassinated ('Uthman, may Allah be pleased with him) and then came asking for revenge for his blood?' He said, *We recited at the time of the Messenger of Allah jg, and Abu Bakr, TJmar and TJthman, iAnd fear the Fittiah (affliction and trial) which affects not in particular (only) those ofyou who do wrong,} We did not think that this Ayah was about us too, until it reached us as it did.'"' 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Ayah, i&L ffc* uM Y iAnd fear the Fitnah (affliction and trial) which affects not in particular (only) tlwse ofyou who do wrong,} refers to the Companions of the Prophet in particular. 121 In another narration from Ibn 'Abbas, he said, "Allah commanded the believers to stop evil from flourishing among them, so that Allah does not encompass them all in the torment (Fitnah)."131 This, indeed, is a very good explanation, prompting Mujahid to comment about Allah's statement, // >-/.V / .if {/ > _ • // » iAnd fear the Fitnah (affliction and trial) which affects not in particular (only) those ofyou who do wrong,} "Is for you too!" Several said similarly, such as Ad- Dahhak and Yazld bin Abi Habib and several others. Ibn Mas*ud said, "There is none among you but there is something that represents a Fitnah for him, for Allah said, 111 Ahmad 1 :165. 121 At-Tabari 13:474. 131 At-Tabari 13:474. 141 At-Tabari 13:475.

290 Tafoir Ibn Katlur iYour wealth and your children are only a trial (Fitnah).. .\$.> (64 :15). Therefore, when you seek refuge, seek it with Allah from the Fitnah that causes misguidance." Ibn Jarir collected this Hadith. [I] The view that the warning in this Ayah addresses the Companions and all others is true, even though the speech in the Ayah was directed at the Companions. There are Hadiths that warn against Fitnah in general, thus providing the correctness of this explanation. Similarly there will be a separate book in which this subject will be discussed, Allah willing, as also is the case with the Imams, there being a number of writings about this. Of the most precise things that have been mentioned under this topic, is what was recorded by Imam Ahmad from Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman that the Messenger of Allah said, r OSJU jJ tX «By He in Whose Hand is my soul! You will enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, or Allah will send a punishment upon you from Him; you will supplicate then to Him, but He will not answer your supplication.^ Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Ar-Riqad said, "I heard Hudhayfah saying, 'A person used to utter one word during the time of the Messenger of Allah jg and become a hypocrite on account of it. I now hear such words from one of you four times in the same sitting. Surely, you will enjoin good, forbid evil and encourage each other to do good or Allah will surround you all with torment, or make the wicked among you become your leaders. The righteous amongyou will then supplicate, but their supplication will not be accepted.'" I3 Imam Ahmad recorded that An-Nu'man bin Bashir said that the Prophet ^ gave a speech in which he said, while pointing to his ears with two of his fingers, 111 At-Tabari 13:475. 121 Ahmad 5:388. 131 Ahmad 5:390.

1fSj fji JLlS yj* (i'^5' J^ j 0LSo la'af-l *. j,n«i ^U? j l j l^la.*»t , j .«i»i ^ jJ *AjiU ^y> (jl*- JUJl Ijiwl Ijl l\$li— ulj &?*> Ij£Jl& {Ji^j j»-»jS'Ji jii : li»j» fy> 'Ay jJj *4 liyt- HU-**- ^y>*j ,_JU IjJbS-l 'The

parable of the person abiding by Allah's order and restrictions in comparison to those who violate them, or sit idle while they are being violated, is that of those who drew lots for their seats in a boat. Some of them got seats in the lower part, which is the most rough and worst part, and the others in the upper. When the farmer needed water, they had to go up to bring water and that troubled the others, so they said, 'Let us make a hole in our share of the ship and get water, saving those who are above us from troubling them, so, if the people in the upper part let the others do what they suggested, all the people of the ship would be destroyed, but if they prevented them, both parties would be safe.'¹ This was recorded by Al-Bukhari, but not Muslim, in the Book of Partnerships and the Book of Witnesses.² It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi through a different route of narration.³ Imam Ahmad recorded that Umm Salamah, the Prophet's wife, said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah saying, 'If sins become apparent in my Ummah, Allah will surround them with punishment from Him. I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Will they have righteous people among them then?' He said, 'Yes. I asked, 'What will happen to them?' He said, 'If they do, they will be safe.'"⁴ Ahmad 4:269. 121 Fath Al-Bari 5 : 157 and 345 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :394

292 Tafsir Ibn Kathir tafsir 'A-staeu IjL. I j!"t;teM0^>-^ O / 1/ #/>/ // * >£ < » / . t ^ 'J iji_J3^JJ^-^ Ij 1 V JaSCjjbliSj^J LxLjUJ, q ljlj fjp '<J.j^=£j2 \j^-*AliV*& 'VjUiJUjjci&£&ilSj)ULL^jiiJli l_^!_!_si^j cryJjVl <£>' >. r; —• * >^ • *'. 'y'. i^#^" \ . ^ I-- pJbj|>^ jjK '-JP L*_J j>J ,^*01 fc—'Lii 11 J? l'A~ ijl ^j'jr^i. *They a)/// be stricken as the people, but they will end up with Allah's forgiveness and pleasure .s"¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jarir said that the Messenger of Allah ^ said, 't'-t-~> J-^"-i fj-^ ,>? if**? ^ -? 'A' ^ b *5?) pJ j*-l , ; * , . * * z .. a^U*j <ul aEvery people among whom sins are being committed, while they are mightier and more numerous than those who do wrong, yet they did nothing to stop them, then Allah will surround them all with punishment'² Ibn Majah collected this Hadith P j-tiP&: J Jii 4 Ji i. (v£=>U -s^*t <26. And remember when you were few and were reckoned weak in the land, and were afraid that men might kidnap you, but He provided a safe place for you, strengthened you with His help, and provided you with good things (for livelihood) so that *** Ahmad 6 :304 121 Ahmad 4 :364 131 Ibn Majah 2:1329 and Ahmad 4 :366.

you might be grateful. Reminding Muslims of their previous state of weakness and subjugation which changed into might and triumph Allah, the Exalted, reminds His believing servants of His blessings and favors on them. They were few and He made them many, weak and fearful and He provided them with strength and victory. They were meek and poor, and He granted them sustenance and livelihood. He ordered them to be grateful to Him, and they obeyed Him and implemented what He commanded. When the believers were still in Makkah they were few, practicing their religion in secret, oppressed, fearing that pagans, fire worshippers or Romans might kidnap them from the various parts of Allah's earth, for they were all enemies of the Muslims, especially since Muslims were few and weak. Later on, Allah permitted the believers to migrate to Al-Madina, where He allowed them to settle in a safe resort. Allah made the people of Al-Madina their allies, giving them refuge and support during Badr and other battles. They helped the Migrants with their wealth and gave up their lives in obedience of Allah and His Messenger Qatadah bin Di'amah As-Sadusi commented, / A •• . \ i And remember when you were few and were reckoned weak in the land, } "Arabs were the weakest of the weak, had the toughest life, the emptiest stomachs, the barest skin and the most obvious misguidance. Those who lived among them lived in misery; those who died went to the Fire. They were being eaten

up, but unable to eat up others! By Allah! We do not know of a people on the face of the earth at that time who had a worse life than them. When Allah brought Islam, He made it dominant on the earth, thus bringing provisions and leadership for them over the necks of people. It is through Islam that Allah granted all what you see, so thank Him for His favors, for your Lord is One Who bestows favors and likes praise. Verily, those who thank Allah enjoy even more bounties

from Him.”¹¹ •Q1 ^ it \j£ V l£K yt £fc> 4\$ZZJ£% »i* 'it llii ,£#! 427. O you who believe! Betray not Allah and His Messenger, nor betray knowingly your Amanat (things entrusted to you)}. 428. And know that your possessions and your children are but a trial and that surely, with Allah is a mighty reward.} Reason behind revealing This Ayah, and the prohibition of Betrayal The Two Sahihs mention the story of Hatib bin Abi Balta'ah. In the year of the victory of Makkah he wrote to the Quraysh alerting them that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) intended to march towards them. Allah informed His Messenger of this, and he sent a Companion to retrieve the letter that Hatib sent, and then he summoned him. He admitted to what he did. Thmar bin Al-Khattab stood up and said, “O Allah’s Messenger! Should I cut off his head, for he has betrayed Allah, His Messenger and the believers?” The Prophet (ﷺ) said, U 1 : dlSi jjj JaI L_ ^ip <2)1 iliajJu Uj 1 1 j-b ji <o[i •l^J Jjyii. jii ijLf «Leave him! He participated in Badr. How do you know that Allah has not looked at those who participated in Badr and said, Do whatever you want, for I have forgiven you. However, it appears that this Ayah is more general, even if it was revealed about a specific incident. * Such rulings are dealt with by their indications, not the specific reasons behind revealing them, according to the majority of scholars. Betrayal includes both minor and major sins, as well those that affect others. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah, 111 At-Tabari 13:478. He is saying this here because he mentioned two unauthentic stories in that regard . Additionally , in the case of Hatib , the Ayah revealed was Al- Mumtahinah 60 : 1 as recorded by Al-Hakim and others

inor betray your Amanat} “The Amanah refers to the actions that Allah has entrusted the servants with, such as and including what He ordained. Therefore, Allah says here, 4nor betray...}, ‘do not abandon the obligations.’” ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd commented, “Allah forbade you from betraying Him and His Messenger, as hypocrites do.” 12’ Allah said, T3 ((And know that your possessions and your children are but a trial.} from Him to you. He grants these to you so that He knows which of you will be grateful and obedient to Him, or become busy with and dedicated to them instead of Him. Allah said in another Ayah, %h xi\} ((Your wealth and your children are only a trial, whereas Allah! With Him is a great reward.} [64:15], Jttj \$&¥ 4And We shall make a trial of you with evil and with good.} [21:35], 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah . And whosoever does that, then they are the losers.^[63:9], and, At-Tabari 13:485. 121 At-Tabari 13:483.

40 you who believe! Verily, among your wives and your children there are enemies for you (who may stop you from the obedience of Allah); therefore beware of them!} [64:14] Allah said next, 4tLki% i'x*& 4And that surely with Allah is a mighty reward.} Therefore, Allah’s reward, favor and Paradise are better for you than wealth and children. Certainly, among the wealth and children there might be enemies for you and much of them avail nothing. With Allah alone is the decision and sovereignty in this life and the Hereafter, and He gives tremendous rewards on the Day of Resurrection. In the Sahih,

there is a Hadith in which the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{J\&' o' 61S jaj i jj jlio}$ «There are three qualities for which whomever has them, he will have tasted the sweetness of faith. (They are:) whoever Allah and His Messenger are dearer to him than anyone else, whoever loves a person for Allah's sake alone, and whoever prefers to be thrown in fire rather than revert to disbelief, after Allah has saved him from it. s' 1 ' Therefore, loving the Messenger of Allah ﷺ comes before loving children, wealth and oneself. In the Sahih, it is confirmed that he jg said, dUj ja Oj y !;Juj «By He in Whose Hand is my soul! None of you will have faith unless I become dearer to him than himself, his family, his wealth and all people jin » Sfr-. *** Muslim 1 :66. 121 Fath Al-Bdri 1 :75.

» . 4 li' ji <l)i ($\text{3ij } ^{29}$. O i/ow who believe! If you obey and fear Allah, He will grant you Furqan, and will expiate for you your sins, and forgive you; and Allah is the Owner of the great bounty.) Ibn 'Abbas, As-Suddi, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhdh, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan and several others said that, $\text{4fc> } ^{\text{Furqan}}$, means, 'a way out'; Mujahid added, "In this life and the Hereafter." 111 In another narration, Ibn 'Abbas is reported to have said, 'Furqan' means 'salvation' or - according to another narration - 'aid'. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that 'Furqan' means 'criterion between truth and falsehood'. This last explanation from Ibn Ishaq is more general than the rest that we mentioned, and it also includes the other meanings. Certainly, those who have Taqwa of Allah by obeying what He ordained and abstaining from what he forbade, will be guided to differentiate between the truth and the falsehood. This will be a triumph, safety and a way out for them from the affairs of this life, all the while acquiring happiness in the Hereafter. They will also gain forgiveness, thus having their sins erased, and pardon, thus having their sins covered from other people, as well as, being directed to a way to gain Allah's tremendous rewards, $\text{\\jj> S^r-J Jt j^bi 'Ay'J. jjjji 1^4^ i ,TA ill'j JLMj iO}$ you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah, and believe in His Messenger, He will give you a double portion of His mercy, and He will give you a light by which you shall walk (straight) And He will forgive you. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} [57:28] %& 'of&j iUy* \$ 4 ifr 430. And (remember) when the disbelievers plotted against you IM At-Jabari 13:489-490.

to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you (from your home, Makkah); they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the best of plotters.) The Makkans plot to kill the Prophet imprison or expel Him from Makkah Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said, iLiyuthbituka means "to imprison you." 111 As-Suddi said, "Ithbat is to confine or to shackle." 121 Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, the author of Al- Maghazi, reported from 'Abdullah bin Abi Najih, from Mujahid, from Ibn 'Abbas, "Some of the chiefs of the various tribes of Quraysh gathered in Dar An-Nadwah (their conference area) and Iblls (Shaytan) met them in the shape of an eminent old man. When they saw him, they asked, 'Who are you?' He said, 'An old man from Najd. I heard that you are having a meeting, and I wished to attend your meeting. You will benefit from my opinion and advice.' They said, 'Agreed, come in.' He entered with them. Iblls said, "You have to think about this man (Muhammad)! By Allah, he will soon overwhelm you with his matter (religion).' One of them said, Imprison him, restrained in chains, until he dies just like the poets before him all died, such as Zuhayr and An-Nabighah! Verily, he is a poet like they were.' The old man from Najd, the enemy of Allah, commented, "By Allah! This is not a good idea. His Lord will release him from his prison to his companions, who will liberate him from your hands. They will protect him from you and they might expel you from your land.' They said. This old man said the truth. Therefore, seek an opinion other than this one.' Another one of them said, 'Expel

him from your land, so that you are free from his trouble! If he leaves your land, you will not be bothered by what he does or where he goes, as long as he is not among you to bring you troubles, he will be with someone else.’ The old man from Najd replied, *By Allah! This At-Tabari 13:492. (2) At-Tabari 13:491.

299 Surah 8 . Al-Anfal (30) (Part-9) is not a good opinion. Have you forgotten his sweet talk and eloquency, as well as, how his speech captures the hearts? By Allah! This way, he will collect even more followers among Arabs, who will gather against you and attack you in your own land, expel you and kill your chiefs.’ They said, ‘He has said the truth, by Allah! Therefore, seek an opinion other than this one.’ Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, spoke next, *By Allah! I have an idea that no one else has suggested yet, and I see no better opinion for you. Choose a strong, socially elevated young man from each tribe, and give each one of them a sharp sword. Then they would all strike Muhammad at the same time with their swords and kill him. Hence, his blood would be shed by all tribes. This way, his tribe, Banu Hashim, would realize that they cannot wage war against all of the Quraysh tribes and would be forced to agree to accept the blood money; we would have brought comfort to ourselves and stopped him from bothering us.’ The old man from Najd commented, *By Allah! This man has expressed the best opinion, and I do not support any other opinion.’ They quickly ended their meeting and started preparing for the implementation of this plan. Jibril came to the Prophet ﷺ and commanded him not to sleep in his bed that night and conveyed to him the news of their plot. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not sleep in his house that night, and Allah gave him permission to migrate. After the Messenger migrated to Al-Madinah, Allah revealed to him Surat Al-Anfal reminding him of His favors and the bounties He gave him, £%& im } \& U\$ 4 Pi >& i And (remember) when the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you (from Makkah); they were plotting and Allah too was plotting ; and Allah is the best of plotters.> Allah replied to the pagans’ statement that they should await the death of the Prophet ﷺ, just as the poets before him perished, as they claimed,

300 Tafafr Ibn Kathfr tl Ji- O;^ ft i Or do they say: "He is a poet! We await for him some calamity by time!" [52:30] |1! As-Suddi narrated a similar story. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Muhammad bin Ja'far bin Az-Zubayr, from 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr who commented on Allah's statement, jy. «jJj iii 'faSj 'ojfazfayp i...they were plotting and Allah too was plotting, and Allah is the best of plotters.} "I (Allah) plotted against them with My sure planning, and I saved you (O Muhammad) from them."121 U^« ^4 ijji ji* Uiil ILls y L. iC jj ijHi j-i fyy} U o*j' y> 4 J-iii 'jJLj ilj Kjffai ^ i'j ii' liS h;.*J Liii) .iLLji ^ 4^— iit 431. Aw/ when Our Aydt are recited to them, they say: "We have heard (the Qur'an); if we wish we can say the like of this. This is nothing but the tales of the ancients."} 432. And (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} 433 . And Allah would not punish them while you (Muhammad ﷺ) are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah's) forgiveness.} The Quraysh claimed They can produce Something similar to the Qur'an Allah describes the disbelief, transgression, rebellion, as well as misguided statements that the pagans of Quraysh used to Sirah Ibn Hisham 1 :480-482. This story as narrated here is not authentic 121 Sirah Ibn Hisham 2 : 325

utter when they heard Allah's Ayat being recited to them, 4'xi Ji* ijiy 4 "We have heard (the Qur'an); if we wish we can say the like of this."} They boasted with their words, but not with their actions. They were challenged several times to bring even one chapter like the Qur'an, and they had no way to meet this challenge. They only boasted in order to deceive themselves and those who followed their falsehood. It was said that An-Nadr bin Al- Harith, may Allah curse him, was the one who said this, according to Sa'id bin Jubayr, As-Suddi, Ibn Jurayj and others. An-Nadr visited Persia and learned the stories of some Persian kings, such as Rustum and Isphandiyar. When he went back to Makkah, He found that the Prophet was sent from Allah and reciting the Qur'an to the people. Whenever the Prophet would leave an audience in which An-Nadr was sitting, An-Nadr began narrating to them the stories that he learned in Persia, proclaiming afterwards, "Who, by Allah, has better tales to narrate, I or Muhammad?" When Allah allowed the Muslims to capture An-Nadr in Badr, the Messenger of Allah j&s commanded that his head be cut off before him, and that was done, all thanks are due to Allah. The meaning of, 4 ...tales of the ancients meaning that the Prophet jg has plagiarized and learned books of ancient people,- and this is what he narrated to people, as they claimed. This is the pure falsehood that Allah mentioned in another Ayah, 4And they say: "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down :, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon." Say: "It (this Qur'an) has been sent down by Him (Allah) Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth. Truly, He is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful."} [25:5-6] for those who repent and return to Him, He accepts repentance from them and forgives them.

The Idolaters ask for Allah's Judgment and Torment! Allah said, Si iljifr ly, iij' y, ill ijilt yij is# ji iAnd (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} This is indicative of the pagans' enormous ignorance, denial, stubbornness and transgression. They should have said, "O Allah! If this is the truth from You, then guide us to it and help us follow it." However, they brought Allah's judgment on themselves and asked for His punishment. Allah said in other Ayat, 4\$ »< •>- '-*• hUj ' 33 VjiJ jijL \$ £%} they ask you to hasten on the torment (for them), and had it not been for a term appointed, the torment would certainly have come to them. And surely, it will come upon them suddenly while they perceive not!} [29:53], -tf. 35 ^4 u J-f Gy ijjO> A'They say: "Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittand (our record of good and bad deeds so that we may see it) before the Day of Reckoning!"} [38:16], and, 4A questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall. Upon the disbelievers, which none can avert. From Allah, the Lord of the ways of ascent.} [70:1-3] The ignorant ones in ancient times said similar things. The people of Shu'ayb said to him, Si££ S Si&} 4 "So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!"}[26:187] while the pagans of Quraysh said.

303 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (31 - 33) (Part-9 <g\ l £2)1 ^& U. ft- <\$"0 A//fl/t/ // f/j/s (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment. Shu*bah said from 'Abdul-Hamid that Anas bin Malik said that it was Abu Jahl bin Hish&m who uttered this statement. Oil } .122)1 i"0 Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment." > So Allah revealed this Ayah, \$And Allah would not punish them while you are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah's) forgiveness Al-Bukhari recorded it. The Presence of the Prophet jg, and the Idolators' asking For forgiveness, were the Shelters against receiving Allah's immediate Torment Allah

said, ii' Uj jrfj c4j i^ 'C.fty iAnd Allah would not punish them while you are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah's) forgiveness.^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Pagans used to go around the House in fawaf and proclaim, *We rush to Your obedience, O Allah, there is no partner with You,' and the Prophet jg would tell them, *jj tJi» «Enough , enoughJ But they would go on, We rush to Your 111 FathAl-Bdri 8:160.

304 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr obedience, O Allah, there is no partner with You except a partner who is with You, You own Him but he does not own! They also used to say, 'O Allah, Your forgiveness, Your forgiveness.' Allah revealed this verse; fit 4Atid Allah would not punish them while you are among them...y" Ibn 'Abbas commented, "They had two safety shelters: the Prophet jg, and their seeking forgiveness (from Allah). The Prophet 2g went away, and only seeking forgiveness remained."111 At-Tirmidhi recorded that Abu Musa said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, •jHgd& fit Jjit. Allah sent down to me two safe shelters for the benefit of my Ummah; fit 4And Allah would not punish them while you are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah's) forgiveness> ajiQJl jliLiYt xLs'j bp uWlien I die, I will leave the seeking of forgiveness with them, until the Day of ResurrectionJ What testifies to this Hadīth, is the Hadīth that Ahmad recorded in his Musnad and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak, that Abu Sa'īd narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, c#? C-alS U IlStlp £3?^ y 'r'j li ^i}ZJ :Jb jUalljl jj» iShaytdn said, 'By Your might, O Lord! I will go on luring Your servants as long as their souls are still in their bodies.' The Lord said, 'By My might and majesty! I will keep forgiving them, as long as they keep invoking Me for forgiveness '»131 At-Tabari 13:511. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi8 : 472 131 Ahmad 3 :29

305 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (34 - 35) (Part-9 Al-Hakim, "Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it."111 >' tit »' ;'•* ,3? • l*J>j (*r4" *> j-v W ^Sj^ 'Jj kX t*J 'n , tL> v>lXji 'Jsji <(34 . And why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Haram, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those who have Taqwa, but most of them know 435. Their Salāh at the House was nothing but Mukd' and Tasdiyah. Therefore taste the punishment because you used to disbelieve. The idolaters deserved Allah's Torment after Their Atrocities Allah states that the idolaters deserved the torment, but He did not torment them in honor of the Prophet residing among them. After Allah allowed the Prophet s£, to migrate away from them, He sent His torment upon them on the day of Badr. During that battle, the chief pagans were killed, or captured. Allah also directed them to seek forgiveness for the m Al-Hakim 4 :261

sins, Shirk and wickedness they indulged in. If it was not for the fact that there were some weak Muslims living among the Makkan pagans, those Muslims who invoked Allah for His forgiveness, Allah would have sent down to them the torment that could never be averted. Allah did not do that on account of the weak, ill-treated, and oppressed believers living among them, as He reiterated about the day at Al-Hudaybiyyah, iJWy Vj jy. O* pfeiy-y yjl ^1} AiIl jju :S' : r >rr i •« *? O' v itf;ci C& G£j^ ji Cf iThey are the ones who disbelieved and hindered you from Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) and detained the sacrificial animals from reaching their place of sacrifice. Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have

punished those of them who disbelieved with painful torment.} [48:25] Allah said here, ol Q6. £&&^ ii»1 j£& vl% Cj} iAnd why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Hardm, and they are not its guardians? Hone can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd, but most of them know not.} Allah asks, “why would not He torment them while they are stopping Muslims from going to Al-Masjid Al-Hardm, thus hindering the believers, its own people, from praying and performing Tawafin it?” Allah said, si tjfc, cj} iAnd they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd,} meaning, the Prophet jgg and his Companions are the true

307 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (34 - 35) (Part-9) dwellers (or worthy maintainers) of Al-Masjid Al-Haram, not the pagans. Allah said in other Ayah, iXf- &£-\$• M c5 tt !\$*S ol St -Ji *K ii3lt ;0J is nof for the polytheists, to maintain the Masjids of Allah, while they witness disbelief against themselves. The works of such are in vain and in the Fire shall they abide. The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Saldh, and give the Zakah and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance [9:17-18], and, 4^1 iig *ii *4^ jrpjj ‘ft >4=»j o <B»f a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankind from following the way of Allah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, [2:217]. ‘Urwah, As-Suddi and Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Allah’s statement, 45,53! -Ji 4SuJ ii> iNone can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd,\$ refers to Muhammad and his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them all. Mujahid explained that this Ayah is about the Mujahidin [in Allah’s cause], whomever and wherever they may be. Allah then mentioned the practice of the pagans next to Al-Masjid Al-Haram and the respect they observed in its vicinity, ih+Zj jLs ’ftkz at IS# iTheir Saldh (prayer) at the House was nothing but Mukd’ and Tasdiyah.} ‘Abdullah bin Umar, Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Raja’ Al-Utardi, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi,

SQp Tafsir Ibn Katlur Hujr bin ‘Anbas, Nubayt bin Sharit, Qatadah and ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this part of the Ayah refers to whistling.’ Mujahid added that the pagans used to place their fingers in their mouth (while whistling).’21 Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statement, ATHeir Salat at the House was nothing but Muka and Tasdiyah “The Quraysh used to perform Tawaf (encircling the Ka’bah) while naked, whistling and clapping their hands, for Muka’ means ‘whistling’, while, Tasdiyah means ‘clapping the hands.’” This meaning was also reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, by ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-‘Awfi. Similar was recorded from Ibn ‘Umar, Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka’b, Abu Salamah bin ‘Abdur-Rahman, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, ‘Atiyyah Al-‘Awfi, Hujr bin ‘Anbas and Ibn Abza. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Umar explained the Ayah, iJ==*i jL^ ^ l iTheir Salat at the House ions nothing but Muka’ and Tasdiyah .} Muka means \whistling’, while, ‘Tasdiyah’ means ‘clapping the hands.’” Said bin Jubayr and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said that, = iand Tasdiyah}, means, they hindered from the path of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored.’3 Allah said, ATherefore taste the punishment because you used to disbelieve.} This refers to the death and capture that they suffered during the battle of Badr, according to Ad-Dahhak, Ibn Jurayj and Muhammad bin Ishaq.’4 ‘ At-Tabari 13:522, 526. At-Tabari 13:525. |3) At-Tabari 13:527. At-Tabari 13:528.

o/3 pj jjl.j Jj^p Ji- IjjuaJ JjkJCj. IfjiS’ 6^ « Sf J^ - 4 ©T r ?U; 4 ,££=>£ £ ,ur ijff jig; 436. Verily, those who disbelieve spend their wealth to hinder (men) from the path of Allah, and so will they continue to spend it; but in the end it will become an anguish for them. Then they will be overcome. And those who

disbelieve will be gathered unto Hell.\$ 437. In order that Allah may distinguish the wicked from the good, and put the wicked one over another, heap them together and cast them into Hell. Those! it is they who are the losers The Disbelievers spend Their Wealth to hinder Others from Allah's Path, but this will only cause Them Grief Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Az-Zuhri, Muhammad bin Yahya bin Hibban, 'Asim bin 'Umar bin Qatadah, and Al- Husayn bin 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Amr bin Said bin Mu'adh said, "The Quraysh suffered defeat at Badr and their forces went back to Makkah, while Abu Sufyan went back with the caravan intact. This is when 'Abdullah bin Abi Rabl'ah, Ikninah bin Abi Jahl, Safwan bin Umayyah and other men from Quraysh who lost their fathers, sons or brothers in Badr, went to Abu Sufyan bin Harb. They said to him, and to those among the Quraysh who had wealth in that caravan, 'O people of Quraysh! Muhammad has grieved you and killed the chiefs among you. Therefore, help us with this wealth so that we can fight him, it may be that we will avenge our losses.' They agreed." Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "This Ayah was revealed about them, according to Ibn 'Abbas, iVerily, those who disbelieve spend their wealth ..> until, ithey who are the losers.y' Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al- m At-Tabari 13:532.

310 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Hakam bin Tîyaynah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Abza said that this Ayah was revealed about Abu Sufyan and his spending money in Uhud to fight the Messenger of Allah jg. Ad-Dahhak said that this Ayah was revealed about the idolaters of BadrJ2 ' In any case, the Ayah is general, even though there was a specific incident that accompanied its revelation. Allah states here that the disbelievers spend their wealth to hinder from the path of truth. However, by doing that, their money will be spent and then will become a source of grief and anguish for them, availing them nothing in the least. They seek to extinguish the Light ofAllah and make their word higher than the word of truth. However, Allah will complete His Light, even though the disbelievers hate it. He will give aid to His religion, make His Word dominant, and His religion will prevail above all religions. This is the disgrace that the disbelievers will taste in this life; and in the Hereafter, they will taste the torment of the Fire. Whoever among them lives long, will witness with his eyes and hear with his ears what causes grief to him. Those among them who sire killed or die will be returned to eternal disgrace and the everlasting punishment. This is why Allah said. It ^ p <&£>} iAtid so will they continue to spend it; but in the end it will become an anguish for them. Then they will be overcome. And those who disbelieve will be gathered unto Hell.} Allah said, crt * *iif iln order that Allah may distinguish the wicked from the good.}, meaning recognize the difference between the people of happiness and the people of misery, according to Ibn 'Abbas, as 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from him. ' Allah 111 At-Tabari 13:530-531. At-Tabari 13:533. •3| At-Tabari 13:534.

322Surah 8. Al-Anfal (37 - 40) (Part-9) distinguishes between those believers who obey Him and fight His disbelieving enemies and those who disobey Him. Allah said in another Ayah, &&£ \j±if u 4& iAlldh will not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wickedfrom the good. Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Chayb (Unseen).} [3:179], and, ! &S£ oj'&£ ti'jm ijS11 3 iDo you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah (tests) those of you who fought (in His cause) and (also) tests those who are the patient?}[3:142]. Therefore, the Ayah (8:37) means, *We tried you with combatant disbelievers whom We made able to spend money in fighting you,' iin order that Allah may distinguish the wickedfrom the good, and put the wicked one over another, heap them together} put in a pile on top of each other, iand cast them into Hell. Those! It is

they who are the losers.} [8:37], in this life and the Hereafter. Sji \j&\$ 22 4 E3&, Sr-jJj fy \j4zl ik ^==* Oj£==yj ilij v (V*i) (t-4 Stf iJ ii' 138. Say to those who have disbelieved, if they cease, their past will be forgiven. But if they return (thereto), then the examples of those (punished) before them have already preceded (as a warning).} 139. And fight them until there is no more Fitnah, and the

313 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (38 - 40) (Part-9) AFut if they return,} and remain on their ways, 4then the examples of those (punished) before them have already preceded. [8:38] meaning, Our way with the nations of old is that when they disbelieve and rebel, We send down to them immediate torment and punishment. The Order to fight to eradicate Shirk and Kufr Allah said, AAndfight them until there is no more Fittiah, and the religion will all be for Allah alone.} Al-Bukhari recorded that a man came to Ibn Umar and said to him, "O Abu 'Abdur-Rahman! Why do you not implement what Allah said in His Book, AAnd if two parties (or groups) among the believers fall to fighting...}[49:9]. What prevents you from fighting as Allah mentioned in His Book?" Ibn Umar said, "O my nephew! I prefer that I be reminded with this Ayah rather than fighting, for in the latter case, I will be reminded by the Ayah in which Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, said, jii'& AAnd whoever kills a believer intentionally...} [4:93]" The man said, "Allah, the Exalted, said, i y AAndfight them until there is no more Fihiah...}." Ibn Umar said, "We did that during the time of the Messenger of Allah, when Islam was weak and the man would be tried in religion, either tormented to death or being imprisoned. When Islam became stronger and widespread, there was no more Ftinah." When the man realized that Ibn Umar would not

314 Tafsir Ibt Kathir agree to what he is saying, he asked him, "What do you say about 'Ali and Uthman?" Ibn 'Umar replied, "What do I say about 'Ali and Uthman! As for Uthman, Allah has forgiven him, but you hate that Allah forgives him. As for 'Ali, he is the cousin of the Messenger of Allah jg and his son-in-law,"¹¹ ' and he pointed with his hand saying, "And this is his house over there." Said bin Jubayr said, "Ibn *Umar came to us and was asked, "What do you say about fighting during Fitnah?" Ibn Umar said, "Do you know what Fitnah refers to? Muhammad jg was fighting against the idolators, and at that time, attending (or residing with) the idolators was a Fitnah (trial in religion). It is nothing like what you are doing, fighting to gain leadership!"² ' All these narrations were collected by Al- Bukhari, may Allah the Exalted grant him His mercy. Ad- Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about the Ayah, \$Andfight them until there is no more Fitnah... "So that there is no more Shirk."³ ' Similar was said by Abu Al-'Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Zayd bin Aslam. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that he was informed from Az-Zuhri, from Urwah bin Az-Zubayr and other scholars that 4*i 'op v iuntil there is no more Fitnah^ the Fitnah mentioned here means, until no Muslim is persecuted so that he abandons his religion.⁴ ' Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4fk iand the religion (worship) will all befor Allah alone. > "So that Tawhid is practiced in sincerity with Allah."⁵ ' Al- Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Jurayj said, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 160 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :160. 131 At-Tabari 13:538. 141 Ibn AbiHatim 5:1701. (5 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 5:1701.

315 Suralt 8. Al-Anfal (38 - 40) (Part-9) iik iand the religion will all be for Allah alone "So that La ilaha illa- llah is proclaimed." ' Muhammad bin Ishaq also commented on this Ayah, "So that Tawhid is practiced in sincerity towards Allah, without Shirk, all the while shunning all rivals who (are being worshipped) besides Him."² ' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said about, iand the religion will

all before Allah alone> “So that there is no more Kufr (disbelief) with your religion remains.”¹³ There is a Hadith collected in the Two Sahihis that testifies to this explanation. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «/ was commanded to fight against the people until they proclaim, ‘There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah.’ If and when they say it, they will preserve their blood and wealth from me, except for its right (Islamic penal code), and their reckoning is with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored ,»⁴ ' Also, in the Two Sahihis, it is recorded that Abu Musa Al- Ash'ari said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was asked about a man who fights because he is courageous, in prejudice with his people, or to show off. Which of these is for the cause of Allah? He said, *J*J 3* J11 J. <&' QS ojzj JLi If 1Whoever fights so that Allah’s Word is the supreme, is in the cause of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored.v*5) Allah said next, At-Tabari 13:538-539. Sirah Ibn Hisham 2 :327 ' At-Tabari 13:539. ' FathAl-Bari 1 :95 and Muslim 1:53. Al-Bukhari nos: 123, 2810, 3126 and 7458

iBut if they ceased, and desist from their Kufr as a result of your fighting them, even though you do not know the true reasons why they did so, Hj iit 4then certainly, Allah is All-Seer of what they do.\$ Allah said in similar Ayah, ijte ijas4\$ 4But if they repent and perform the Saldh, and give Zakdh, then leave their way free [9:5], 4<£**!' j 4 ...then they are your brethren in religion . \$> [9:1 1], and, 4 o'jj* "% <1 £/jIT 3/jj V^ f •{And fight them until there is no more Fitnalt and the religion (worship) is for Allah (alone). But if they cease, let there be no transgression except against the wrongdoers .£ [2:193] It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to Usamah bin Zayd when he overpowered a man with his sword, after that man proclaimed that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah; 3>i V ii] % ?Sii ill i jii u Ju; “How you killed him after he proclaimed, ‘Id lldha Illalldh’? What would you do with regard to ‘La lldha Illalldh’ on the Day of Resurrection . Usamah said, “O Allah’s Messenger! He only said it to save himself.” The Messenger jfe replied, h?aJL5 ji- c-Sii •Did you cut his heart open ?» The Messenger^ kept repeating, fa Jj)l ilj % ill “What would you do with regard to ‘La lldha Illalldh’ on the Day

of Resurrection ?» until Usamah said, “I wished I had embraced Islam only that day.” 1 11 Allah said next, sSS 3 j*-v 4And i/ they turn away, then know that Allah is your protector, an excellent protector, and an excellent helper!\$> Allah says, if the disbelievers persist in defying and fighting you, then know that Allah is your protector, master and supporter against your enemies. Verily, what an excellent protector and what an excellent supporter. J U!3S8i&5 'AT [Jo*—jl? jlj '-•'W'. 'aX'" Jcl-J'v <" " •""l » > >»'•> / / *-V i*» . »> •""Tf . » > >>V' / •>.A, £35 &sk^ ^ k ^ C3w f5 }y. *+2 £ Ty k\ o\ ^5(J 4\$W *r ^=*% s£^j' 3\$ 442. And know that whatever of war booty that you may gain, verily, one-fifth of it is assigned to Allah, and to the Messenger, and to the near relatives (of the Messenger), the orphans, the poor, and the wayfarer, if you have believed in Allah and in that which I have sent down to Our servant on the Day of Criterion, the Day when the two forces met; and Allah is able to do all things. I 1 * Muslim 1 :96.

ik verily, one-fifth of it is assigned to Allah\$ is inclusive [of the Messenger’s share], just as the following Ayah is inclusive [of Allah owning whatever is on the earth also], j Cj 4 U fs& iTo Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and on the earth\$[2:284]. ,1) So He addressed the share of Allah and the share of His Messenger 2g in the same statement. Ibrahim An-Nakha‘i, Al-Hasan bin Muhammad bin Al- Hanifiyyah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ash-Sha'bi, ‘Ata’ bin Abi Rabah, ‘Abdullah bin Buraydah,

Qatadah, Mughlrah and several others, all said that the share designated for Allah and the Messenger is one and the same.¹² Supporting this is what Imam Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded, with a Sahih chain of narrators, that 'Abdullah bin Shaqq said that a man from Bilqin said, "I came to the Prophet sgg when he was in Wadi Al-Qura inspecting a horse. I asked, 'O Allah's Messenger! What about the Ghanimah?' He said, j l j > 4|D ^Allah's share is one fifth andfour-fifths arefor the army. I asked, *None of them has more right to it than anyone else?' He said, u>-l »No. Even ifyou remove an arrow that pierced your flank, you have no more right to it tlnw your Muslim brother.s"*³¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Miqdam bin Ma'dikarib Al- Kindi sat with 'Ubadah bin As-šamit, Abu Ad-Darda' and Al- Harith bin Mu'awiyah Al-Kindi, may Allah be pleased with them, reminding each other of the statements of the Messenger of Allah sg. Abu Ad-Darda' said to Ubadah, "O Ubadah! What about the words of the Messenger of Allah during such and such battle, about the fifth (of the war At-Jabari 13:549. At-Jabari 13:548, 550. I3 * As-SunanAl-Kubra, by Al-Bayhaqi 6 :324

the war booty for himself; a servant, a horse, or a sword, according to the reports from Muhammad bin Sirin, 'Amir Ash- Sha'bi and many scholars. For instance, Imam Ahmad and At- Tirmidhi - who graded it Hasan - recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger of Allah sg chose a sword called Dhul-Fiqar on the day of BadrJ 'A'ishah narrated that Safiyyah was among the captured women, and the Prophet chose [and married] her (upon his own choice and before distribution of war booty), as Abu Dawud narrated in the Sunan.¹² As for the share of the Prophet's relatives, it is paid to Bani Hashim and Bani Al-Muttalib, because the children ofAl-Muttalib supported Bani Hashim in Jahiliyyah after Islam. They also went to the mountain pass of Abu Talib in support of the Messenger of Allah jg and to protect him (when the Quraysh boycotted Muslims for three years). Those who were Muslims (from Bani Al-Muttalib) did all this in obedience to Allah and His Messenger jg, while the disbelievers among them did so in support of their tribe and in obedience to Abu Talib, the Messenger's uncle. Allah said next, Athe orphans in reference to Muslim orphans, iand the wayfarer}, the traveler and those who intend to travel for a distance during which shortening the prayer is legislated, but do not have resources to spend from. We will explain this subject in Surah Bara'h [9:60], Allah willing, and our reliance and trust is in Him alone. Allah said, ilfyou have believed in Allah and in that which We sent down to Our servant} Allah says, 'Adhere to what We legislated for you, such as the ruling about one-fifth of the war spoils, ifyou truly believe in Allah, the Last Day and what We have revealed to Our *** Ahmad 1 :271 and At-Tirmidhi: 1561 * Abu Dawud : 2994

ijA-JljJ f^==Ut Sr <Sj**il' jj-iiit fkj Lilli ijlill <j* ^iJL* -24+i Vjiin iif (jffl JliLjl ^ ••j£iV 4:><;.U Lq 'if -<>- f-- •' — -'•' i42. (And remember) when you (the Muslim army) were on the near side of the valley, and they on the farther side, and the caravan on the ground lower than you. Even ifyou had made a mutual appointment to meet, you would certainly have failed in the appointment, but (you met) that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained (in His knowledge), so that those who were to be destroyed (for rejecting the faith) might be destroyed after a clear evidence, and those who were to live (believers) might live after a clear evidence. And surely, Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} Some Details ofthe Battle ofBadr Allah describes Yawm Al-Furqan, (i.e. the day of Badr), 4Clif ii» i(And remember) when you (the Muslim army) were on the near side of the valley,} camping in the closest entrance of the valley towards Al- Madlnah, iand they}, the idolators, who were camped, hZii} ion thefarther side}, from Al-Madlnah, towards Makkah. iand the caravan}, that was under the command

of Abu Sufyan, with the wealth that it contained, on the ground lower than you}, closer to the sea, on

even if you had made a mutual appointment to meet,} you and the idolators, if you would certainly have failed in the appointment Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "Yahya bin 'Abbad bin 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr narrated to me from his father about this Ayah "Had there been an appointed meeting set between you and them and you came to know of their superior numbers and your few forces, you would not have met them, ill ibut (you met) that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained,} Allah had decreed that He would bring gloiy to Islam and its people, while disgracing Shirk and its people. You [the companions] had no knowledge this would happen, but it was out of Allah's compassion that He did that." ' In a Hadlth, Ka'b bin Malik said, "The Messenger of Allah jg and the Muslims marched to intercept the Quraysh caravan, but Allah made them meet their (armed) enemy without appointment."21 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Yazid bin Ruwman narrated to him that 'Urwah bin Az-Zubayr said, "Upon approaching Badr, the Messenger of Allah sg sent 'Ali bin Abi Talib, Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas, Az-Zubayr bin Al-'Awwam and several other Companions to spy the pagans. They captured two boys, a servant of Bani Said bin A1-'As and a servant of Bani Al-Hajjaj, while they were bringing water for Quraysh. So they brought them to the Messenger of Allah jg, but found him praying. The Companions started interrogating the boys, asking them to whom they belonged. Both of them said that they were employees bringing water for Quraysh (army). The Componions were upset with that answer, since they thought that the boys belonged to Abu Sufyan (who was commanding the caravan). So they beat the two boys vehemently, who said finally that they belonged to Abu Sufyan. Thereupon companions left them alone. When the Prophet jg ended the prayer, he said, Ibn HishSm 2 :328. ' At-Tabari 13:566.

tJ-iA M! i ijij 'as ijij> J* jy.rA «When they tell you the truth you beat them, but when they lie you let than go? They have said the truth, by Allalt! They belong to the Quraysh. (addressing to the boys He said:) Tell me the neivs about Quraysh. » The two boys said, They are behind this hill that you see, on the far side of the valley.' The Messenger of Allah jg asked, pin *How many are they? » They said, They are many.' He asked, eHow many? 11 They said, We do not know the precise number.' He asked, A" *How many camels do they slaughter every day? They said, "Nine or ten a day.' The Messenger of Allah said, MV l <5L«. *...:ll jZ Li "They are betweai nine-hundred and a thousand.* He asked again, ^ bi r+i 'Which chiefs of Quraysh are accompanying the army?*' They said, TJtbah bin Rabl'ah, Shaybah bin Rabl'ah, Abu Al- Bakhtari bin Hisham, Hakim bin Hizfim, Nawfal bin Khuwaylid, Al-Harith bin 'Amir bin Nawfal, Tu'aymah bin Adi bin Nawfal, An-Nadr bin Al-Harith, Zam'ah bin Al-Aswad, Abu Jahl bin Hisham, Umayyah bin Khalaf, Nablh and Munabbih sons of Al-Hajjaj, Suhayl bin 'Amr and 'Amr bin 'Abd Wadd.' The Messenger of Allah^ said to the people, 1L&JuS p^lij oJl iSLi ;Jlat "This is Makkahl She has brought you her most precious sons

(its chiefs)!*'w Allah said, if i^iJ if iSo that those who were to be destroyed might be destroyed after a clear evidence.} [8:42] Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, "So that those who disbelieve do so after witnessing clear evidence, proof and lessons, and those who believe do so after witnessing the same."*2 * This is a sound explanation. Allah says, He made you meet your enemy in one area without appointment, so that He gives you victory over them.' This way, 'He will raise the word of truth above

falsehood, so that the matter is made clear, the proof unequivocal and the evidence plain. Then there will be no more plea or doubt for anyone. Then, those destined to destruction by persisting in disbelief do so with evidence, aware that they are misguided and that proof has been established against them, and those who were to live might live}, those who wish to believe do so, Rafter a clear evidence}, and proof. Verily, faith is the life of the heart, as Allah said, 4os&4 </y %&Z l? 'Jr if ils he who was dead (without faith by ignorance and disbelief) and We gave him life (by knowledge and faith) and set for him a light (of belief) whereby he can walk among men ...} [6:122]. Allah said next, iyz&^j} iAnd surely, Allah is All-Hearer}, of your invocation, humility and requests for His help, **' Ibn Hisham 2 :268 Although this version is not authentic, no. 1779 of Muslim , and 948 of Musnad Ahmad are witnesses for it. * At-Tabari 13:568.

4All-Knower} meaning; about you, and you deserve victory over your rebellious, disbelieving enemies. o &4 jj; ^ 4 it -4 >1 iis f;^t ^A it tfv J*t v Jij 'iyu* fpi «ili ij -XfejUp ^Lli 443. (And remember) when Allah showed them to you as few in your dream; if He had shown them to you as many, you would surely have been discouraged, and you would surely have disputed in making a decision. But Allah saved (you). Certainly, He is the All-Knower of that is in the breasts.} 444. And (remember) when you met. He showed them to you as few in your eyes and He made you appear as few in their eyes, so that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained, and to Allah return all matters (for decision).} Allah made each Group look few in the Bye of the Other Mujahid said, "In a dream, Allah showed the Prophet the enemy as few. The Prophet jg conveyed this news to his Companions and their resolve strengthened."* 11 Similar was said by Ibn Ishaq and several others.*21 Allah said, 4If He had shown them to you as many, you would surely, have been discouraged,} you would have cowardly abstained from meeting them and fell in dispute among yourselves, 4j& Sat 4But Allah saved}, from all this, when He made you see them as few, At-Jabari 13:570. At-Tabari 13:570.

jLic fj>\} 4Certainly , He is the All-Knower of that is in the breasts.} [8:43]. Allah knows what the heart and the inner-self conceal, Jj& j\$Z} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes, and all that the breasts conceal [40:19]. Allah's statement, m -± w si» iAnd (remember) when you met, He slwved them to you as few in your eyes} demonstrates Allah's compassion towards the believers. Allah made them see few disbelievers in their eyes, so that they would be encouraged and feel eager to meet them. Abu Ishaq As-Subail said, that Abu TJbaydah said that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "They were made to seem few in our eyes during Badr, so that I said to a man who was next to me, 'Do you think they are seventy?' He said, 'Rather, they are a hundred.' However, when we captured one of them, we asked him and he said, *We were a thousand.'" 1 11 Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded it. Allah said next, ti iand He made you appear as few in their eyes,} Allah said, it >i^ ij> iAnd (remember) when you met. He showed them to you...}, He encouraged each of the two groups against the other, according to 'Ikrimah, as recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim.121 This statement has a Sahih chain of narrators. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Yahya bin 'Abbad bin 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr narrated to him that his father said about Allah's statement, 111 At-Tabari 13:572. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 5:1710.

J) ugaifes *at «iasa f/iflf A//fl/i mig/tf p>; j.ssj.w* \y accomplish a matter al- _>":b i ready ordained, "In order for the war t , <>iry ' v\' ' ,, ;>"< to start between i them - s° that He ijj^ would have revenge aSainst those whom He decided to have J^SoIsaKoItS^lfesOX^ljoJ^* revenge (pagans), and ~ grant and

complete ojl His favor upon those tessi<S- "e decided *° E; ant -r = ^ " favor to. His supporters."111 The '\ ' \> ". ' " meaning of this, is Cp that Allah encouraged isCflj»ijyL^==>Si' each BrouP against /,<- > >/.>,,sv .>s >> the other and made iUjiVy '~-rJ -u-yj JJfv^j— J J ('-4-6i yj them look few in each ^ ' <\ \ °ther s eyes > so that '//'>'a :, ' ^ they were ea^er to meet them. This <*&* << .»<?*>"V occurred before the © J battle started, but when it started and Allah supported the believers with a thousand angels in succession, the disbelieving group saw the believers double their number. Allah said, „ j *1* £21 gS» 4 j£3 Ji)> v JjS? Cs-J 4 'i'l w^L (*4<ih iTltere has already been a sign for you (O jews) in the two armies that met (in combat, the battle of Badr). One was fighting in the cause ofAllah, and as for the other, (they) were disbelievers. They (disbelievers) saw them (believers) with their I 1 ' Ibn Hisham 2 :328 and Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1710.

own eyes twice their number. And Allah supports with His aid whom He wills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand.) [3:13] This is how we combine these two Ayat, and certainly, each one of them is true, all the thanks are due to Allah and all the favors are from Him. C2fc> ii' 445. O you who believe! When you meet (an enemy) force, take a firm stand against them and remember Allah much, so that you may be successful. 446. And obey Allah and His Messenger, and do not dispute (with one another) lest you lose courage and your strength departs, and be patient. Surely, Allah is with the patients.) Maimers ofWar Allah instructs His faithful servants in the manners of fighting and methods of courage when meeting the enemy in battle, 4\£& 2J t'H Cfe> 40 you who believe! When you meet (an enemy) force, take a firm stand against them In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that 'Abdullah bin Abi Awfa said that during one battle, Allah's Messenger ^ waited until the sun declined, then stood among the people and said. 4)1 \j)L\j ijJLajt #UJ \ • jJj I V ,>01 l*5l U» i &Ji SI \fiSkj «0 people! Do not wish to face the enemy (in a battle) and ask Allah to save you (from calamities). But ifyou should face the enemy, then be patient and let it be known to you that Paradise is under the shadows of the swords . He then stood and said, iv-^UJLJl jiJt (. JjU jltl» »*. l'ic y u-

332Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (45 - 46) (Part-10 «0 Allah! Revealer of the (Holy) Book, Mover of the clouds, and Defeater of the Confederates, defeat them and grant us victory over them -*11 ' The Command for Endurance when the Enemy Engaging Allah commands endurance upon meeting the enemy in battle and ordains patience while fighting them. Muslims are not allowed to run or shy away, or show cowardice in battle. They are commanded to remember Allah while in that condition and never neglect His remembrance. They should rather invoke Him for support, trust in Him and seek victoiy over their enemies from Him. They are required to obey Allah and His Messenger jfe in such circumstances adhering to what He commanded them, and abstaining from what He forbade them. They are required to avoid disputing with each other, for this might lead to their defeat and failure, ilest your strength departs}, so that your strength, endurance and courage do not depart from you, iand be patient. Surely, Allah is with the patients.} In their courage, and obedience to Allah and His Messenger, the Companions reached a level never seen before by any nation or generation before them, or any nation that will ever come. Through the blessing of the Messenger ^ and their obedience to what he commanded, the Companions were able to open the hearts, as well as, the various eastern and western parts of the world in a rather short time. This occurred even though they were few, compared to the armies of the various nations at that time. For example, the Romans, Persians, Turks, Slavs, Berbers, Ethiopians, Sudanese tribes, the Copts and the rest of the Children ofAdam. They defeated all of these

nations, until Allah's Word became the highest and His religion became dominant above all religions. The Islamic state spread in 'Fath Al-Bari 6:140 and Muslim 3:1362.

over the eastern and western parts of the world in less than thirty years. May Allah grant them His pleasure, as well as, be pleased with them all, and may He gather us among them, for He is the Most Generous, and Giving. J* <X& ' & JJ ')) ^ a* * 3\$; ^ ^ # % % ifju c r-- ^ ' 2/! 41 3lij Je- Cjtiiii ff "£ j-llli Jy-^4 », 'i j.j_1 iiij ii(illl ^ y £ **' i*' > JO \$3?*_ _> jJi? 447 . And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah; and Allah is Muhit (encompassing and thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.) i48. And (remember) when Shaytan made their (evil) deeds seem fair to them and said, "No one of mankind can overcome you this day (of the battle of Badr) and verily, I am your neighbor (for each and every help)." But when the two forces came in sight of each other, he ran away and said "Verily, I have nothing to do with you. Verily, I see what you see not. Verily, I fear Allah for Allah is severe in punishment.") 449. When the hypocrites and those in whose hearts was a disease (of disbelief) said : "These people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion." But whoever puts his trust in Allah, then surely, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.) The Idolators leave Makkah, heading for Badr After Allah commanded the believers to fight in His cause sincerely and to be mindful of Him, He commanded not to imitate the idolators, who went out of their homes i)boastfully to suppress the truth, i)and to be seen of men), boasting arrogantly with people. When Abu Jahl was told that the caravan escaped safely, so they should return to Makkah, he commented, "No, by Allah! We will not go back until we proceed to the well of Badr, slaughter camels, drink alcohol and female singers sing to us. This way, the Arabs will always talk about our stance and what we did on that day." However, all of this came back to haunt Abu Jahl, because when they proceeded to the well of Badr, they brought themselves to death; and in the aftermath of Badr, they were thrown in the well of Badr, dead, disgraced, humiliated, despised and miserable in an everlasting, eternal torment. This is why Allah said here, i)and Allah is Muhit (encompassing and thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.} He knows how and what they came for, and this is why He made them taste the worst punishment. ' Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi commented on Allah's statement, Uijj i)And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men,} "They were the idolators who fought against the Messenger of Allah sg at Badr."*2 ' Muhammad bin Ka*b said, "When the Quraysh left Makkah towards Badr, they brought female singers and drums along. Allah revealed this verse, ii'j Wj-* - oA*-*2 i)And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah; and Allah is Muhit (encompassing and thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.} Ibn Hisham 2 :329. 121 At-Tabari 14:8-9.

— Tafsir Ibn Kathir Shaytan makes Evil seem fair and deceives the Idolators Allah said next, X OiS usdif ait * Je^ i)And (remember) when Shaytan made their (evil) deeds seem fair to them and said, "No one of mankind can overcome you today and verily, I am your neighbor."} Shaytan, may Allah curse him, made the idolators' purpose for marching seem fair to them. He made them think that no other people could defeat them that day.' ' He also ruled out the possibility that their enemies, the tribe of Bani Bakr, would attack Makkah, saying, "I am your neighbor." Shaytan appeared to them in the shape of Suraqah bin Malik bin Ju'shum, the chief of Bani Mudlij, so that, as Allah described them, i)He [Shaytan] makes

promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions (4: 120). Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, (8:48) "On the day of Badr, Shaytan, as well as, his flag holder and soldiers, accompanied the idolaters. He whispered to the hearts of the idolaters, 'None can defeat you today! I am your neighbor.' When they met the Muslims and Shaytan witnessed the angels coming to their aid, he ran away, he went away in flight while proclaiming, 'Verily, I see what you see not.'"

4, Verily, I see what you see not.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said, that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah, At-Jabari 14:11. At-Tabari 14:9.

4 % OIJ fj? r^- 1 vi£ "5^ <"No one of mankind can overcome you today and verily, I am your neighbor"} "Shaytan, as well as, his devil army and flag holders, came on the day of Badr in the shape of a Suraqah bin Malik bin Ju'shum, man from Bani Mudlij, Shaytan said to idolaters, 'None will defeat you this day, and I will help you.' When the two armies stood face to face, the Messenger of Allah jg took a handful of sand and threw it at the faces of the idolaters, causing them to retreat. Jibril, peace be upon him, came towards Shaytan, but when Shaytan, while holding the hand of a Mushrik man, saw him, he withdrew his hand and ran away with his soldiers. That man asked him, 'O Suraqah! You claimed that you are our neighbor?*' He said, j iilj o_tP V l> <X>! 4Verily, I see what you see not. Verily, I fear Allah Jbr Allah is severe in punishment} Shaytan said this when he saw the angels." The Position of the Hypocrites in Badr Allah said next, iWhen the hypocrites and those in whose hearts was a disease (of disbelief) said : "These people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion."} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "When the two armies drew closer to each other, Allah made the Muslims look few in the eyes of the idolaters and the idolaters look few in the eyes of the Muslims. The idolaters said, iThese people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion.} because they thought that Muslims were so few. They believed, without doubt, that they would defeat the Muslims. Allah said, At-Tabari 14:7.

4%~==*- Srif iBut whoever puts his trust in Allah, then surely, Allah is All- Mighty, All-Wise.) il] Qatadah commented, "They saw a group of believers who came in defense of Allah's religion. We were informed that when he saw Muhammad j§ and his Companions, Abu Jahl said, By Allah! After this day, they will never worship Allah!' He said this in viciousness and transgression."*21 'Amir Ash-Sha'bi said, "Some people from Makkah were considering embracing Islam, but when they went with the idolaters to Badr and saw how few the Muslims were, they said,*31 %) iThese people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion .) Allah said next, 4i»'& iBut whoever puts his trust in Allah), and relies on His grace, 4*? ithen surely, Allah is All-Mighty), and verily, those who take His side [in the dispute] are never overwhelmed, for His side is mighty, powerful and His authority is All-Great, 4U^> iAll-Wise) in all His actions, for He places everything in its rightful place, giving victory to those who deserve it and defeat to those who deserve it. \ \ * ' mJL" > s > *' Ji'if f >r \ Cj\$ \ ^ JJf ii' u-i llj ^4'i 450. And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve (at death); they smite their faces and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 4 :78 At-Jabari 14:14. At-Jabari 14:13.

337 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (50 - 51) (Part-10 their backs, (saying): "Taste the punishment of the blazing Fire."} 451. "This is because of that which your hands forwarded. And verily, Allah is not unjust to His servants."} The Angels smite the Disbelievers upon capturing Their Souls Allah says, if you witnessed the angels capturing the souls of the disbelievers, you would witness a tremendous, terrible, momentous

and awful matter, 4they smite their faces and their backs}, saying to them, 4"Taste the punishment of the blazing Fire."} Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that, 4and their backs}, refers to their back sides, as happened on the day of Badr. Ibn Jurayj also reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "When the idolaters faced the Muslims [in Badr], the Muslims smote their faces with swords. When they gave flight, the angels smote their rear ends." Although these Ayat are describing Badr, they are general in the case of every disbeliever. This is why Allah did not make His statement here restrictive to the disbelievers at Badr, 8^-, fj} 4And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve (at death); they smite their faces and their backs,} In Surat Al-Qital (or Muhammad chapter 47) there is a similar Ayah, as well as in Surat Al-An'am, 4p=a-j) Ipi-C ,£>>* J >1 Tijj 'ff} 4And if you could but see when the wrongdoers are in the At-Tabari 14:16.

agonies of death, while the angels are stretching forth their hands (saying) : "Deliver your souls!"} [6:93] The angels stretch their hands and smite the disbelievers by Allah's command, since their souls refuse to leave their bodies, so they are taken out by force. This occurs when the angels give them the news of torment and Allah's anger. There is a Hadith narrated from Al-Bara' that when the angel of death attends the disbeliever at the time of death, he comes to him in a terrifying and disgusting shape, saying, "Get out, O wicked soul, to fierce hot wind, boiling water and a shadow of black smoke." The disbeliever's soul then scatters throughout his body, but the angels retrieve it, just as a needle is retrieved from wet wool. In this case, veins and nerve cells will be still attached to the soul.' Allah states here that angels bring news of the torment of the Fire to the disbelievers. Allah said next, lrfji XLj o2f>} }This is because of that which your hands forwarded.} meaning, this punishment is the recompense of the evil deeds that you have committed in the life of the world. This is your reckoning from Allah for your deeds, 4 Jill Silt \$j} iAnd verily, Allah is not unjust to His servants.} Certainly, Allah does not wrong any of His creatures, for He is the Just, who never puts anything in an inappropriate place. Honored, Glorified, Exalted and Praised be He, the All- Rich, Worthy of all praise. Muslim recorded that Abu Dharr said that the Messenger of Allah jgj said; (^4; ^ jJall c-S/S- ,y[&lip U : JjZ Sul up Sill .uAili J/Si USJ U l jilUaJ •Allah , the Exalted, said, 'O My servants! I have prohibited injustice for Myself, and made it prohibited to you between each other. m Ahmad 4:287-288

339Surah 8. Al-Anfal (50 - 51) (Part-10) S UlSSli&S ut am» X, 4c /.'•*, ^ > -J .'•"5 »>' i ',' / 3fA4* <^j A^Ci l Therefore, do not commit injustice against each other. OMy servants! It is your deeds that I am keeping count of, so whoever found some- thing good, let him praise Allah for it. Who- ever found other than that, has only himself to blame. This is why Allah said, «A b», jc J2> jiiji-li -ult Cili> (i-4^ iji. &f !>t £f i52. Similar to the behavior of the people of Fir'awn, and of those before them - they rejected the Aydt ofAllah, so Allah punished them for their sins. Verily, Allah is All-Strong, severe in punishment.} Allah says. The behavior of these rebellious disbelievers against what I sent you with, O Muhammad, is similar to the behavior of earlier disbelieving nations. So We behaved with them according to Our Dat, that is, Our behavior [or custom] and way, as We did with them with what We often do and decide concerning their likes, the denying people of Fir'awn and the earlier nations who rejected the Messengers and disbelieved in Our Ayat,' irrj*& iso Allah punished themfor their sins.} 3V) . • , . > - < ,/' > "i I 1 * Muslim 4 :1994.

Because of their sins, Allah destroyed them iVerily, Allah is All-Strong, severe in punishment\$ none can resist Him or escape His grasp. -CSl> ^ it- (5 siT >^4'^ (ity vA'i i+ij c>i 4'* '-4-*^= 4'* tv-^j <53. That is so because Allah will never change a grace which He has bestowed on a people until they change what is in themselves. And verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} 454. Similar to the behavior of the people of Fir'axan, and those before them. They belied the Ayat of their Lord, so We destroyed them for their sins, and We drowned the people of Fir'awn for they were all wrongdoers .} Allah affirms His perfect justice and fairness in His decisions, for He decided that He will not change a bounty that He has granted someone, except on account of an evil that they committed. Allah said in another Ayah, u Ji Cj /i lj* yl ill j'J iijJ ^—ii\ l> b-A" ,£»• sjjj 4: " -J'-> # yuo iVerily, Allah will not change the (good) condition of a people as long as they do not change their state (of goodness) themselves. But when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning it back, and they will find besides Him no protector.} [13:111 Allah said next, 4Similar to the behavior of the people ofFir'awn,} meaning, He punished Fir'awn and his kind, those who denied His Ayat. Allah destroyed them because of their sins, and took away the favors that He granted them, such as gardens, springs, plants, treasures and pleasant dwellings, as well as all of the delights that they enjoyed. Allah did not wrong them,

341Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (55 - 57) (Part-10 but it is they who wronged themselves. r "V isy'S" 5-J' ji' i-c ji 0* -*+? -0"-* 4 [>r**^* ^ 3\djil-j V J£=> j ^55. Verily, the worst of living creatures before Allah are those who disbelieve, - so they shall not believe.} 456. They are those with whom you made a covenant, but they break their covenant every time and they do not have Taqwdf 457. So if you gain the mastery over them in war, then disperse those who are behind them, so that they may learn a lesson.} Striking Hard against Those Who disbelieve and break the Covenants Allah states here that the worst moving creatures on the face of the earth are those who disbelieve, who do not embrace the faith, and break promises whenever they make a covenant, even when they vow to keep them, }and they do not have Taqiod} meaning they do not fear Allah

regarding any of the sins they commit.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2212–2239]

4So ifyou gain the mastery over them in zvar}, ifyou defeat them and have victory over them in war, V-if*} 4then disperse those who are behind them,} by severely punishing [the captured people] according to Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, 'Ata' Al- Khurasani and Ibn 'Uyaynah. * This Ayah commands punishing them harshly and inflicting casualties on them. This way, other enemies, Arabs and non-Arabs, will be afraid and take a lesson from their end, m At-Tabari 14:23-24.

iso that they may learn a lesson. As-Suddi commented, “They might be careful not to break treaties, so that they do not meet the same end.” 44 y ii* 4 2C»r f} or. £0 i58. If you fear treachery from any people, throw back (their covenant) to them (so as to be) on equal terms. Certainly Allah likes not the treacherous.} make a heading, Allah says to His Prophet 5H, ilf you fear from any people}, with whom you have a treaty of peace, i^} itreachery}, and betrayal of peace treaties and agreements that you have conducted with them. iX0\ ±&} itthen throw back (their covenant) to them}, meaning their treaty of peace. ion equal terms}, informing them that you are severing the treaty. This way, you will be on equal terms, in that, you and they will be aware that a state of war exists between you and that the bilateral

peace treaty is null and void, iU-\$\$ 44 'J 4^ iCertainly Allah likes not the treacherous.} This even includes treachery against the disbelievers. Imam Ahmad recorded that Salim bin 'Amir said, "Mu'awiyah was leading an army in Roman lands, at a time the bilateral peace treaty was valid. He wanted to go closer to their forces so that when the treaty of peace ended, he could invade them. An old 111 At-Tabari 14:24.

343SuraJi 8. Al-Anfal (59 - 60) (Part-10 man riding on his animal said, 'AUahu Akbar (Allah is the Great), AUahu AkbarI Be honest and stay away from betrayal.' The Messenger of Allah si said, till: v'j LiU Su jiy > }4^L- *Whoever has a treaty of peace with a people, then he should not untie any part of it or tie it harder until the treaty reaches its appointed term. Or, he should declare the treaty null and void so that they are both on equal terms. When Mu'awiyah was informed of the Prophet's statement, he retreated. They found that man to be 'Amr bin 'Anbasah, may Allah be pleased with him." ' This Hadthh was also collected by Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Hibban in his Sahih. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahth.'^ »y lyi U (V+I V lyjji jClic Sj} **? **<*,*; O . . < ' if ^ , - i ,.f» , *#> V c>i Jj*' Jjc ^ ^ O* .far- 459. And let not those who disbelieve think that they can outstrip (escape from the punishment). Verily, they will never be able to save themselves (from Allah's punishment).} 460. And make ready against them all you can of power, including steeds ofwar to threaten the enemy ofAllah and your enemy, and others besides them, whom you may not know but whom Allah does know. And whatever you shall spend in the cause of Allah shall be repaid unto you, and you shall not be treated unjustly.} MakingPreparationsforWarto strike Fearin theHearts ofthe Enemies ofAllah Allah says to His Prophet jg, in this Ayah, *** Ahmad 4:111. ' Abu Dawud At-Tayfilisi : 157, Abu Dawud 3:190, At-Tirmidhi 5 -.203 , An-Nasal 5 :223 and Ibn Hibban 7 :182

4'y~- 4f/jose who disbelieve think that they can outstrip}, Do not think that such disbelievers have escaped Us or that We are unable to grasp them. Rather, they are under the power ofOur ability and in the grasp of Our will; they will never escape Us.' Allah also said, ^ o' OK iJl Ojli ujlll ('7 iOr think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us (escape Our punishment)? Evil is that which they judge!} [29:4], && fife tjyVf 4 iConsider not that the disbelievers can escape in tle land. Their abode shall be the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination .} [24:57], and, fi% ZU& (Ml 4 iLet not the free disposal (and affluence) of the disbelievers throughout the land deceive you. A brief enjoyment ; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that placefor rest.} [3:196-197] Allah commands Muslims to prepare for war against disbelievers, as much as possible, according to affordability and availability. Allah said, iJZLJ t; fi \fjff } }And make ready against them all you can} whatever you can muster, iof power, including steeds of war}. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Uqbah bin 'Amir said that he heard the Messenger of Allah 5% saying, while standing on the Minbar, / 'S. 4}y ot t; fi \ifij} iAnd make ready against them all you can ofpower,}

345Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (59 - 60) (Part-10) Si £*)\ 5jiii Si « Verily, Power is shooting! Power is shooting .s1 ' 1 Muslim collected this HadlthJ2 Imam Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Messenger of Allah jfe said, '3=4 ij ^iJi Cli Ojj ^5 *34 J^515 *3^ J*-> j^" • ' * * ifLt j> ui ji £> t?? ^ ? *' J^-" J^3i . * "-d I tf4» Jjdaj tfjl >J oils- <d O-ils' > (t3^ ,>? *4^ 4 ^o> j!j »«J ol^j- ijfr* 3' ^> igU.j ^>1 (J-r3^^ dllSj 'd oLl> dlta jLS <. j-> jl ^4 1445 j>-55 '34 % Vj J* 55* 1 34 45 '&~5^ •3i> 4* ,4 jv '*'>15 Jlij5 '3^ «Horses are kept for one of three purposes ; for some people they are a source of

reward, for some others they are a means of shelter, and for some others they are a source of sin . The one for whom they are a source of rezoard, is he zoho keeps a horse for Allah's cause (Jihad) tying it with a long tether on a meadoio or in a garden . The result is that zuhatever it eatsfrom the area of the meadow or the garden where it is tied, will be counted as good deeds for his benefit; and if it should break its rope andjump over one or tzoo hillocks then all its dung and its footmarks will be ivritten as good deeds for him . If it passes by a river and drinks water from it, even though he had no intention of watering it, then he will get the reward for its drinking. Therefore, this type ofhorse is a source ofgood deeds for him . As for the man who tied his horse maintaining self - sufficiency and abstinence from begging, all the "while not forgetting Allah's right concerning the neck and back of his horse, then it is a means of shelter for him. And a man who tied a horse for the sake of pride, pretense and showing enmity for Muslims, then this type ofhorse is a source of sins. 11 Ahmad 4:156. ' Muslim 3 : 1522

When Allah's Messenger jg was asked about donkeys, he replied, «;iu3i UjUJi ivi .ii ^ Jii jjii u> "Nothing has been revealed to mefrom Allah about them except these unique, comprehensive Ayat 'fj- i)» fci- jji jLSZ jIUfr iThen anyone who does an atom's weight ofgood, shall see it. And anyone who does an atom's weight of evil, shall see it.^s (99:7-8j,,m Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this Hadith, this is the wording of Al-Bukhari. (a| Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas*Qd said that the Prophet jg said, o' ^ tjllby Ir'jj >jUallij ly'j'j Jlijlt ut_> - 4)1 iti li JSij - *}yj -4jjj 1 4) ^jju JI Lrfa ' [y'j jk'f JI JiUj ^jJli tuUallll uThere are three reasons why horses are kept: A horse that is kept for Ar-Rahmdn (the Most Beneficent), a horse kept for Shaytdn and a horse kept for the man . As for the horse kept for Ar-Rahmdn, it is the horse that is being kept for the cause of Allah (for Jilwd), and as such, its food, dung and urine, etc., (he made mention of many things). As for the horse that is for Shaytdn, it is one that is being used for gambling. As for the horse that is for man, it is the horse that one tethers, seeking its benefit. For him, this horse will be a shield against poverty .» ,3) Al-Bukhari recorded that TJrwah bin Abi Al-Ja'd Al-Bariqi said that the Messenger of Allah Eg said, ^rrVl liiOJl fJJ ^\ JliJl J> lyX* Jlijl> "Good will remain in the forelocks of horses until the Day of Al-Muwatta 2:414. t2 ' Al-Bukhari : 2860 and Muslim : 987 131 Ahmad 1:395.

347Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (59 - 60) (Part-10) Resurrection, (that is) reward, and the spoils ofwar. n' 11 Allah said next, ito threaten}, or to strike fear, ithe enemy ofAllah and your enemy}, the disbelievers, Ji iand others besides them}, such as Bani Qurayzah, according to Mujahid,121 or persians, according to As-Suddi.13 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah refers to hypocrites, 141 as supported by Allah's statement, *5 vi>Vf^ ££ } 4And among the bedouins around you, some are hypocrites, and so are some among the people ofAl-Madtnah who persist in hypocrisy; you know them not, We know them.}[9:101\ . Allah said next, 4And whatever you shall spend in the cause of Allah shall be repaid to you, and you shall not be treated unjustly.} Allah says, whatever you spend on Jihad will be repaid to you in full. We also mentioned Allah's statement, JtSi gi cSS&& ifm 4 ifj fe* ifi 4The parable of those wlv spend their wealth in the way of Allah, is 111 FathAl-Bari 6:66 121 At-Jabari 14:36. 131 At-Jabari 14:36. 141 At-Tabari 14:36.

349Surah 8. Al-Anfal (61 - 63) (Part-10) }But if they incline}, and seek, ito peace}, if they resort to reconciliation, and seek a treaty of non-hostility, 4l/oi/ also incline to it}, and accept offers of peace from them. This is why when the pagans inclined to peace in the year of Hdaybiyah and sought

cessation of hostilities for nine years, between them and the Messenger of Allah he accepted this from them, as well as, accepting other terms of peace they brought forth. ‘Abdullah bin Al-Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali bin Abi Talib said that the Messenger of Allah $\text{ag said, } \bullet \text{ JLUL j}\text{f}\text{, j}\text{l j}\text{\^1}$ “ «There will be disputes after me, so if you have a way to end them in peace, then do so.® Allah said next, iand trust in Allah.} Allah says, conduct a peace treaty with those who incline to peace, and trust in Allah. Verily, Allah will suffice for you and aid you even if they resort to peace as a trick, so that they gather and reorganize their forces, ithen verily, Allah is All-Sufficientfor you}. Reminding the Believers of Allah’s Favor of uniting Them Allah mentioned His favor on the Prophet Sfe, in that He aided him with believers, the Muhajirin and the Ansar, l1 ' Ahmad 1:90.

350 Tahir Ibn Kathir iHe it is Who has supported you with His help and with the believers. And He has united their hearts. The Ayah says, ‘it is Allah who gathered the believers’ hearts, believing, obeying, aiding and supporting you - OMuhammad,’ ZM Z f j j £ iiat ft ilf you had spent all that is in the earth, you could not have united their hearts.} because of the enmity and hatred that existed between them. Before Islam, there were many wars between the Ansar tribes of Aws and Khazraj, and there were many causes to stir unrest between them. However, Allah ended all that evil with the light of faith, 'oK ^ if*** £. it -JZX. if iAnd remember Allah'sfavor on you, for you were enemies one to another, but He united your hearts, so that, by His grace, you became brethren, and you were on the brink of a pit of Fire, and He saved you from it. Thus Allah makes His Ayat clear to you, that you may be guided.} [3:103] In the Two Sahths, it is recorded that when the Messenger of Allah jg gave a speech to the Ansar about the division of war booty collected in the battle of Hunayn, he said to them, Vj V; r*V\$ jtiiVi u» «0 Ansar! Did I not find you misguided and Allah guided you by me, poor and Allah enriched you by me, and divided and Allah united you by me?’ Every question the Prophet jg asked them, they said, “Truly, the favor is from Allah and His Messenger.”111 Allah said. iBut Allah has united them. Certainly He is All-Mighty, All- Wise. Fath Al-Bdri 7 :644 and Muslim 2 :738

351 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (64 - 66) (Part-10) He is the Most Formidable, and the hopes of those who have trust in Him, never end unanswered; Allah is All-Wise in all of His decisions and actions. tfjf oj; osu i^u 2^4 •£-; j&. 4 ‘46# ittf '-iii- cjsif 'J p» ij>S" Si oi^j OjJijl tjtLw >SK f&i J>2 0lj 0|CjU l£liu ‘j\£> iU (>^=C; ^2 oU uli» ^64. O Prophet! Allah is sufficientfor you andfor the believers whofollow you.) 465. O Prophet! Urge the believers to fight. If there are twenty steadfast persons among you, they will overcome two hundred, and if there be a hundred steadfast persons they will overcome a thousand of those who disbelieve, because they (the disbelievers) are people who do not understand.) 466. Now Allah has lightened your (task), for He knows that there is weakness in you. So if there are of you a hundred steadfast persons, they shall overcome two hundred, and if there are a thousand ofyou, they shall overcome two thousand by the leave ofAllah. And Allah is with the patient.) Encouraging Believers to fight in Jihad; the GoodNews that a Few Muslims can overcome a Superior Enemy Force Allah encourages His Prophet and the believers to fight and struggle against the enemy, and wage war against their forces. Allah affirms that He will suffice, aid, support, and help the believers against their enemies, even if their enemies are numerous and have sufficient supplies, while the believers are few. Allah said, 4&i' £ 40 Prophet! Urge the believers to fight), encouraged and called them to fight. The Messenger of Allah jg used to encourage the Companions to fight when they faced the enemy. On the day of Badr when the idolaters came with their forces and supplies,

352 Tafsir Ibn Kathir he said to his Companions, *Umayr bin al-Humam* said, "As wide as the heavens and earth?" The Messenger *Jibril* said, *Umayr* said, "Excellent! Excellent!" The Messenger *Jibril* asked him, "What makes you say, 'Excellent! Excellent?'" He said, "The hope that I might be one of its dwellers." The Prophet *Jibril* said, "If it is so, you are one of its people." *Umayr* went ahead, broke the scabbard of his sword, took some dates and started eating from them. He then threw the dates from his hand, saying, "Verily, if I lived until I finished eating these dates, then it is indeed a long life." He went ahead, fought and was killed, may Allah be pleased with him. ¹ Allah said next, commanding the believers and conveying good news to them. *Si* *I* *524* *J&E* *U* *^* *pip* *ilf* there are twenty steadfast persons among you, they will overcome two hundred, and if there be a hundred steadfast persons, they will overcome a thousand of those who disbelieve.} The Ayah says, one Muslim should endure ten disbelievers. Allah abrogated this part later on, but the good news remained. *Abdullah bin al-Mubarak* said that *Jarir bin Hazim* narrated to them that, *Az-Zubayr bin al-Kharrith* narrated to him, from *Ikrimah*, from Ibn *Abbas*, "When this verse was (i) Muslim 3 .1511

353 Surah 8. Al-Anfal (64 - 66) (Part-10 revealed, *pi* *JZ* .!> if there are twenty steadfast persons among you, they will overcome two hundred...) it became difficult for the Muslims, when Allah commanded that one Muslim is required to endure ten idolators. Soon after, this matter was made easy, *Jit* *i* Now Allah has lightened your (task)}, until. it they shall overcome two hundred...} Allah lowered the number [of adversaries that Muslims are required to endure], and thus, made the required patience less, compatible to the decrease in numbers." ¹¹¹ *Al-Bukhari* recorded a similar narration from Ibn *Al-Mubarak* .^{*21} *Muhammad bin Ishaq* recorded that Ibn *Abbas* said, "When this Ayah was revealed, it was difficult for the Muslims, for they thought it was burdensome since twenty should fight two hundred, and a hundred against a thousand. Allah made this ruling easy for them and abrogated this Ayah with another Ayah, < } *j#* *jfc* *Jit* *i* Now Allah has lightened your (task), for He knows that there is weakness in you ...} Thereafter, if Muslims were half as many as their enemy, they were not allowed to run away from them. If the Muslims were fewer than that, they were not obligated to fight the disbelievers and thus allowed to avoid hostilities." ^{*31} *ill* *13*] • *VJi* *Ji'* *jff* ** *^* *J* *&* } *it* *^* *it* *\&j* *t#* *Abu Dawud* 3 :105. *Fath al-Bari* 8 :163 *Al-Bukhari*: 4652-4653.

i Were it not a previous ordinance from Allah..., "In the Preserved Book, that war spoils and prisoners of war will be made allowed for you, *i* would have touched you for what you took}, because of the captives. *E&L* } 4a severe torment.} Allah, the Exalted said next, 4 So enjoy what you have gotten of booty in war, lawful and good}." *Al-A'wfi* also reported this statement from Ibn *Abbas*. ¹¹ * A similar statement was collected from *Abu Hurayrah*, *Ibn Mas'ud*, *Said bin Jubayr*, *'Ata'*, *Al-Hasan al-Basri*, *Qatadah* and *Al-A'mash*.^{*2} * They all stated that, } Were it not a previous ordinance from Allah..} refers to allowing the spoils of war for this Ummah. Supporting this view is what the Two Sahih recorded that *Jabir bin 'Abdullah* said that the Messenger of Allah *Jibril* said, *^* *'di* ? *p* *C_lap* { » *P'* *d* *'Cj&j* *d* 4-j 4_r-VJl *d* *d* *i* } *Sj* *tip* *llll* *j* </ have been given five things which were not given to any Prophet before me. (They are :) Allah made me victorious by awe, (by His frightening my enemies) for a distance of one month's journey. The earth has been made a place for praying and a purifier for me. The booty has been made lawful for me, yet it = *At-Jabari* 14:65. *At-Jabari* 14:65-69.

was not lawful for any- one else before me. I have been given the right of intercession (on the Day of Resurrection). Every Prophet used to be sent to his people only, but I have been sent to all mankind. Al-A'mash narrated that Abu Salih said that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, 9^4 xJjJ' «War booty was never allowed for any among mankind except ws.» [Abu Hurayrah said;] This is why Allah the Most High said, 4So enjoy what you have gotten of booty in war, lawful and good.y® The Muslims then took the ransom for their captives. In his Sunan, Imam Abu Dawud recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah fixed four hundred (Dirhams) in ransom from the people of Jdhiliyyah in the aftermath of Badr.l3 ' The majority of the scholars say that the matter of prisoners of war is up to the Imam. If he decides, he can have them killed, such as in the case of Bani Qurayzah. If he 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :519 and Muslim 1 :370. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :474 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 : 352 131 Abu Dawud 3:139. jL-k-ji'5 3^ ' *-T~=CX**>'tjff 'of) f' •> •; - jfLji/Vljlj\ -'j0

357Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (70 - 71) (Part-10) decides, he can accept a ransom for them, as in the case of the prisoners of Badr, or exchange them for Muslim prisoners. The Messenger jg exchanged a woman and her daughter who were captured by Salamah bin Al-Akwa', for exchange of some Muslims who were captured by the idolators, or ifhe decides he can take the prisoner as a captives. l*-i liji- 4 (i*. oi iJ—I-V' If-ti^ Jj ii' 'jiLi- Jii jjj jy* ii'j -ip' ix iifj 470. O Prophet! Say to the captives that are in your hands : "If Allah knows any good in your hearts , He will give you something better than what has been taken from you, and He will forgive you, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful/> 471. But if they intend to betray you, they indeed betrayed Allah before. So He gave (you) power over them. And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise PaganPrisoners atBadrwerepromisedbetterthanwhat They lost, ifTheybecome Righteous in the Future Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said that before the battle of Badr, the Messenger of Allah sgg said, p-JJ if-IA V Ij>-j>-\\ JiS lit zjb If 'j li&b • « l X X , , 'I «* * f • r , i Jr. Crt lit - '^-t 0lfi jC-: 'J, ^ </ have come to know that some peoplefrom Bani Hdshim and others wereforced to accompany the pagans, although they had no desire to fight us. Therefore, whoever meets any of them (Bani Hashim), do not kill him. Whoever meets Abu Al- Bukhtari bin Hishdm, should not kill him. Whoever meets Al- Abbas bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, let him not kill him, for he was forced to come (with the pagan army). Abu Hudhayfah bin *Utbah said, "Shall we kill our fathers, children, brothers and tribesmen (from Quraysh), and leave Al- 'Abbas? By Allah! If I meet him, I will kill him with the sword."

o jjjjj Y !<il3 Y 'No, by Allah! Do not leave any Dirham of if. And from Yunus Biklar, from Muhammad bin Ishaq, from Yazid bin Ruwman, from Urwah, from Az-Zuhri that several people said to him, "The Quraysh sent to the Messenger of Allah j££ concerning ransoming their prisoners, and each tribe paid what was required for their prisoners. Al-'Abbas said, 'O Allah's Messenger! I became a Muslims before.' The Messenger ofAllah said, eu ia i% Jii ty jjl us Jin 61 40^' 6? crJ'j *j4i J; *rO^' tri J 1 ,j;* * * ~m T* * * ^ knows ifyou are Muslim! If what you are claiming is true, then Allah will compensate you. As for your outward appearance, it was against us. Therefore, ransom yourself, as well as, your nephews Nawfal bin Al-Hdrith bin 'Abdul- Muttalib and 'Aqtl bin Abu Tdlib bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, and also your ally 'Utbah bin 'Amr, from Bani Al-Hdrith bin Fihir.» Al-'Abbas said, 'I do not have that (money), O Allah's Messenger!' The Messenger sH said. iIJla {£ jj : I4J cJUi jjiM fj cjt JiiS ^Jl JUJI *?l 4lfS-j jJiill J£»S (_jjjl JUJI Lifi "What about the wealth that you and Umm Al-Fadl buried, and you said to her, 'If I am killed in this battle, then this money that I buried is for my children Al-Fadl,

‘Abdullah and Quthm?» Al-‘Abbas said, *By Allah, O Allah’s Messenger! I know that you are Allah’s Messenger, for this is a thing that none except Umm Al-Fadl and I knew. However, O Allah’s Messenger! Could you count towards my ransom the twenty Uwqiyah (pertaining to a weight) that you took from me (in the battle)?’ The Messenger of Allah said, •ill* Juj Jit i^i. b^i Y» 111 FathAl-BOri 7:373.

«No, for that was money that Allah made as loar spoils for ns from yoio. So Al-‘Abbas ransomed himself, his two nephews and an ally, and Allah revealed this verse, jy-t ii'i jiiy f£=-C.; .iJ 40 Prophet! Say to the captives that are in your hands: "If Allah knows any good in your hearts, He loill give you something better than what has been taken from you, and He will forgive you, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."4 [8:70] Al-‘Abbas commented, ‘After I became Muslim, Allah gave me twenty servants in place of the twenty Uwqiyah I lost. And I hope for Allah’s forgiveness. Al-Hafi? Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded, that Anas bin Malik said, “The Prophet sfe was brought some wealth from Bahrain and said; „ t | ,>• aDistribute it in my Masjid» and it was the biggest amount of goods Allah’s Messenger had ever received. He left for prayer and did not even look at the goods. After finishing the prayer, he sat by those goods and gave some of it to everybody he saw. Al-‘Abbas came to him and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! give me (something) too, because I gave ransom for myself and ‘Aqll.’ Allah’s Messenger^ told him to take. So he stuffed his garment with it and tried to carry it away but he failed to do so. He said, ‘Order someone to help me in lifting it.’ The Prophet sg refused. He then said to the Prophet jg, “Will you please help me to lift it?’ Allah’s Messenger jg refused. Then Al-‘Abbas dropped some of it and lifted it on his shoulders and went away. Allah’s Messenger \$£g kept on watching him till he disappeared from his sight and was astonished at his greediness. Allah’s Messenger did not get up until the last coin Al-Qurtubi 8:52. This Hadith is not authentic. Some of the information in it is supported by a Hadith recorded by At-Tabarani and others, see Majma' Az-Zawa'id no. 11033 and Majma ' Al- Bahrayn no . 3318.

362Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (70 - 71) (Part-10 was distributed.” * Al-Bukhari also collected this Hadlth in several places of his Sahih*2 ' with an abridged chain, in a manner indicating his aprpral of it. Allah said, TOR1 Oi *#> iBut if they intend to betray you, they indeed betrayed Allah before meaning, l oIj4 4But if they intend to betray you) in contradiction to what they declare to you by words. 4& oi 4they indeed betrayed Allah before), the battle of Badr by committing disbelief in Him, 4So He gave (you) power over them), causing them to be captured in Badr, 4Zg. is \$&) 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.) He is Ever Aware of his actions and All-Wise in what He decides. ijji* igillj ^ (vf— *>—*» o^jjt ivj't: Jt C ojlj jfo tlj' 0>lu-ju Cj <ilj j^uj ^=CU» ju)i 4 ojj 472. Verily, those who believed, and emigrated and strove hard and fought with their property and their lives in the cause of Allah as well as those who gave (them) asylum and help, - [1 * Al-Bayhaqi 6 :356. '2| Al-Bukhari : 42 1 , 3049 and 3165. The abridged chain is part of the one quoted by Al-Bayhaqi , that chain is itselfused by Al-Bukhari in other places of his Sahih.

these are (all) allies to one another. And as to those who believed but did not emigrate, you owe no duty ofprotection to them until they emigrate, but if they seek your help in religion, it is your duty to help them except against a people with whom you have a treaty of mutual alliance; and Allah is the All-Seer ofwhat you do.} The Muhajirin and Al-Ansar are the Supporters ofOne Another Here Allah mentions

the types of believers, dividing them into the Muhajirin, who left their homes and estates, emigrating to give support to Allah and His Messenger to establish His religion. They gave up their wealth and themselves in this cause. There are also the Ansar, the Muslims of Al-Madlnah, who gave asylum to their Muhajirin brethren in their own homes and comforted them with their wealth. They also gave aid to Allah and His Messenger by fighting alongside the Muhajirun. Certainly they are, Rallies to one another}, for each one of them has more right to the other than anyone else. This is why Allah's Messenger jgg forged ties of brotherhood between the Muhajirin and Ansar, as Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas.¹¹¹ They used to inherit from each other, having more right to inheritance than the deceased man's relatives, until Allah abrogated that practice with the fixed share for near relatives. Imam Ahmad recorded that Jarir bin 'Abdullah Al-Bajali said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said, *T7ie Muhajirun and Al-Ansdr are the supporters of each other, while the Tulaqd' of Quraysh (whom the Prophet M set free after conquering Makkah) and 'Utaqd' from Thaqif (whom the Prophet set free from captivity after the battle of Hunayn) are supporters of each other until the Day of Resurrection .» (i) Fath Al-B&ri 12:30.

363 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (72) (Part-10 Only Ahmad collected this HadithJ Allah praised the Muhajirin and the Ansar in several Ayat of His Book and His Messenger^ (also praised them too). Allah said, «•*** iii(,>&Vfj Jt oy~f)A frij ALP i »«; *->1 * I l_4^ p-* -***-*> iAttd the foremost to embrace Islam of the Muhajirun and the Ansar and also those who followed them exactly. Allah is well- pleased with them as they are well-pleased with Him. He has prepared for them gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise).>[9:100] A'6-^&& 4£\$ 'S# ^} AAllah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar whofollowed him in the time of distress.} [9:117], and, <if Si i>£&< Ji S?' ^ Oi c£i\$J JW C/J() {Jjoyjiitf jU jiljiyy Sit S'? jij <i£4fc> lyj t-i ti "i> j^l iS 4(And f/iere is a/so a s/wre in this booty) for the poor Muhajirin, who were expelled from their homes and their property, seeking bounties from Allah and (His) good pleasure, and helping Allah and His Messenger. Such are indeed the truthful. And those who, before them, had homes (in Al- Madinah) and adopted the faith, love those who emigrate to them, and have no jealousy in their breasts far that which they have been given, and give them (emigrants) preference over themselves even though they were in need of that} [59:8-9]. The best comment on Allah's statement, i#} "jj} A...and have no jealousy in their breasts for that which they have been given} 111 Ahmad 4:363.

is that it means, they do not envy the Muhajirin for the rewards that Allah gave them for their emigration. These Ayat indicate that the Muhajirin are better in grade than the Ansar, and there is a consensus on this ruling among the scholars. The BelieversWho did not emigrate did not yet receive the Benefits of Wilayah Allah said, iS*- itsr- JI JQ 1* isit'c !£*' iAnd as to those who believed but did not emigrate, yon owe no duty of protection to them until they emigrate, [8:72]. This is the third category of believers, those who believed, but did not perform Hijrah and instead remained in their areas. They do not have any share in the war booty or in the fifth [designated for Allah and His Messenger, the relatives of the Prophet the orphans, the poor and the wayfarer], unless they attend battle. Imam Ahmad recorded that Buraydah bin Al-Haslb Al-Aslami said, "When the Messenger of Allah would send a commander with an expedition force or an army, he would advise him to have Taqwa of Allah and be kind to the Muslims under his command. He used to say, y* 'ijji-0.4I lil i4)L yS > Ijhli i«il jJ—^J 4)1 jisii t\$[u ji - dti>- Jj pi . yfj- >~iSj JjU i (*'^-^[1 Jj p-#*ii • pi** '(*4-? p-\$i ji JiJi jj j ft jj jf Jj IjjiitJ \y\

Oji JI Ji- U p.felp dlj U p^** (* p-fr^ p^jc-li £-* *j' V] jJiJl J ji-jJ o_j^e Vj JU vl«5j p+ip JiSte L_jjl»j jji ;Uapl JI p4*^ tljll pi jU i. JJ— ».ll pi jiilj Iji' jji ip-fie- «Fig/if /« f/ie Name ofAllah, in the cause ofAllah. Fight those who disbelieve in Allah. When you meet your Mushrik enemy, then call them to one of three choices, and whichever they agree

365 Surah 8. Al-Anfdl (73) (Part-10) to, then accept it and turn away from them. Call them to embrace Islam, and if they agree, accept it from them and turn away from them. Then call them to leave their area and come to areas in which the Muhajirin reside. Make known to them that if they do this, they will have the rights, as well as, the duties of the Muhajirin. If they refuse and decide to remain in their area, make known to them that they will be just like Muslim bedouins, and that Allah's law applies to them just as it does to all believers. However, they will not have a share in the war booty or Fat' (booty without war), unless they perform jihad along with Muslims. If they refuse all of this, then call them to pay the Jizyah, and if they accept, then take it from them and turn away from them. If they refuse all these [three] options, then trust in Allah and fight them. Muslim collected this Hadith. Allah said next. {But if they seek your help in religion it is your duty to help them.} Allah commands, if these bedouins, who did not perform Hijrah, ask you to aid them against their enemy, then aid them. It is incumbent on you to aid them in this case, because they are your brothers in Islam, unless they ask you to aid them against disbelievers with whom you have a fixed-term treaty of peace. In that case, do not betray your treaties or break your promises with those whom you have treaties of peace. This was reported from Ibn 'Abbas. 131 Jfjii Joai iL3j1 'ctM 473. And those who disbelieve are allies of one another, (and) if you (Muslims) do not do so (protect one another), there will be Fitnah on the earth, and great corruption. 111 Ahmad 5:352. 121 Muslim 3 :1357. 131 At-Tabari 14:83.

Me Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Disbelievers are Allies of Each Other; the Muslims are not their Allies After Allah mentioned that the believers are the supporters of one another, He severed all ties of support between them and the disbelievers. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that Usamah said that the Prophet jg said, V ' "No followers of two religions inherit from each other. Therefore, neither a Muslim inherits from a disbeliever nor a disbeliever from a Muslim. The Prophet sg recited this Ayah, iAnd those who disbelieve are supporters of one another, (and) if you (Muslims) do not do so (protect one another), there will be Fitnah on the earth, and great corruption. Al-Hakim said, "Its chain is Sahih, and they did not record it." 11 * However, the following, from Usamah bin Zayd, is in the Two Sahih; the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^isdi Yj 'j&\ iNeither a Muslim inherits from a disbeliever nor a disbeliever inherits from a Muslim. »|2) Allah said next, j?#4 if you do not do so, there will be Fitnah and oppression on the earth, and a great corruption}, meaning, if you do not shun the idolaters and offer your loyalty to the believers, Fitnah will overcome the people. Then confusion [polytheism and corruption] will be rampant, for the believers will be mixed with disbelievers, resulting in tremendous, widespread trials [corruption and mischief] between people. Al-Hakim 2:240. Fath Al-Bari 12 :51 and Muslim 3 :1233

474. And those who believed, and emigrated and strove hard in the cause of Allah (Al-Jihad), as well as those who gave (them) asylum and aid - these are the believers in truth, for them is forgiveness and a generous provision.} 475. And those who believed afterwards, and emigrated and strove hard along with you, they are of you. But kindred by blood are nearer to one another (regarding inheritance) in the

decree ordained by Allah. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} Believers in Truth After Allah affirmed the ruling of loyalty and protection between the believers in this life, He then mentioned their destination in the Hereafter. Allah also affirmed the faith of the believers, just as mentioned in the beginning of this Surah, and that He will reward them with forgiveness and by erasing their sins, if they have any. He also promised them honorable provisions that are abundant, pure, everlasting and eternal; provisions that never end or run out, nor will they ever cause boredom, for they are delightful and come in great varieties. Allah then mentioned that those who follow the path of the believers in faith and performing good deeds, will be with them in the Hereafter. Just as Allah said, 4And the foremost to embrace Islam...} (9:100), until the end of the Ayah. He also said, 4fa M J iAnd those who came after them ...} (59:10). A Hadith that is in the Two Sahih, which is Mutawatir and has several authentic chains of narrations, mentions that the Messenger of Allah said,

“One will be in the company of those whom he loves. d Another Hadith states, «He who loves a people is one of them*, and in another narration, he jg said, “r*” >~D * ...will be gathered with them (on the Day of Resurrection) Inheritance is for Designated Degrees of Relatives Allah said, 4 u-?*<0 4But kindred by blood are nearer to one another (regarding inheritance) in the decree ordained by Allah}, meaning, in Allah’s decision. This Ayah encompasses all relatives, not only the degrees of relatives who do not have a fixed, designated share in the inheritance, as some people claim and use this Ayah to argue. According to Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and several others,13* this Ayah abrogated inheriting from those with whom one had ties of treaties or brotherhood, as was the case in the beginning of Islam. So it applies to all relatives, and as for those who do not inherit, then this is supported by the Hadith, . . X " » jl J A4>- .1; «Indeed Allah had allotted every right to the one who deserves it, so there may be no will for an heir.*|4 Therefore, this Ayah also includes those who have a fixed share of inheritance. Allah knows best.

Surah 9: At-Tawbah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Which Was Revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2240–2256]

Jr cma* \M e&m rWM M ^ 'a?f J •Art i c\j 4-*Jj\Jfjit zfyryj ^ ^d)\> \ di. ;->< .fr .> 1 ».' '>'> *i . \< >" o)j oV» ><uy*j j j}^Zo\\$zS['-u3 > >>,?x > xx >^ — r^TTf V ' -T> . *xi X". '«; ' m iy~ '*J Sj' Ji, viA« «*' bi '4r# CA fMr \p% 2# ^jft 4 •> ^x., *<, tj, ,> i£ji£ *u\ Alii x'-' 42 . Freedom from (all) obligations (is declared) from Allah and His Mes- senger (sij to those of the Mushrikin (idola- ters), with whom you made a treaty 42. So travel freely (0 Mushrikin) for four months (as you will) throughout the land, but know that you cannot escape (from the punish- ment of) Allah; and Al- lah will disgrace the disbelievers .>

Why there is no Basmalah in the Beginning of This Surah This honorable Surah (chapter 9) was one of the last Surahs to be revealed to the Messenger of Allah 3g. Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara' said, "The last Ayah to be revealed was, 4jih£3i 4 iif J» <±Is>&l j^

iThey ask you for a legal verdict. Say: "Allah directs (thus) about Al-Kaldlah.'>(4: 176] while the last Surah to be revealed was Bar&'ah. „{1] The Basmalah was not mentioned in the beginning of this Surah because the Companions did not write it in the complete copy of the Qur'an (Mushaf) they collected, following the Commander of the faithful, TJthman bin 'Affan, may Allah be pleased with him. The first part of this honorable Surah was revealed to the Messenger of Allah jg when he returned from the battle of Tabok, during the Hajj season, which the Prophet j§ thought about attending. But he remembered that the idolaters would still attend that Hajj, as was usual in past years, and that they perform Tawaf around the House while naked. He disliked to associate with them and sent Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, to lead Hajj that year and show the people their rituals, commanding him to inform the idolaters that they would not be allowed to participate in Hajj after that season. He commanded him to proclaim, 4jslAy\$M iFreedom from (all) obligations (is declared) from Allah and His Messenger (M)---\$, to the people. When Abu Bakr had left, the Messenger jj§ sent 'Ali bin Abu Talib to be the one to deliver this news to the idolaters on behalf of the Messenger jgg, for he was the Messenger's cousin. We will mention this stoiy later. Publicizing the Disavowal of the Idolaters Allah said. iFreedom from obligations from Allah and His Messenger is a declaration of freedom from all obligations from Allah and His Messenger 3g§, ijt^ i-ji oKjV' 4 Si ^-4^ Sil HI Fath Al-B&ri8 :167 . This Surah was commonly called Bara'ah.

ito those of the Mushrikin, with whom you made a treaty. So travel freely (Mushrikin) for four months (as you will) throughout the land^ [9:1-2]. This Ayah refers to idolaters who had indefinite treaties and those, whose treaties with Muslims ended in less than four months. The terms of these treaties were

restricted to four months only. As for those whose term of peace ended at a specific date later (than the four months), then their treaties would end when their terms ended, no matter how long afterwards, for Allah said, in? 4So fulfill their treaty for them until the end of their term>[9:4]. So whoever had a covenant with Allah's Messenger jg then it would last until its period expired, this was reported from Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and others. We will also mention a Hadith on this matter. Abu Ma'shar Al-Madani said that Muhammad bin Ka*b Al- Qurazi and several others said, "The Messenger of Allah sent Abu Bakr to lead the Hajj rituals on the ninth year (of Hijrah). He also sent 'Ali bin Abi Talib with thirty or forty Ayat from Bara'ah (At-Tawbah), and he recited them to the people, giving the idolaters four months during which they freely move about in the land. He recited these Ayat on the day of 'Arafah (ninth of Dhul-Hijjah). The idolaters were given twenty more days (till the end) of Dhul-Hijjah, Muharram, Safar, Rabi' Al- Awwal and ten days from Rabi' Ath-Thani. He proclaimed to them in their camping areas, "No Mushrik will be allowed to perform Hajj after this year, nor a naked person to perform Tawaf around the House."2 ' So Allah said, £ 3#S 3&& gU £ o-M J) J* Jf) jifea1 jSi- 111 At-Tabari 14:106-102. ' Al-Tabari 6:304. The chain of narrators is not authentic. Al-Bukhari recorded a similar Hadith with different wording . Seeno . 4363

43. And a declaration from Allah and His Messenger to mankind on the greatest day of Hajj that Allah is free from obligations to the Mushrik and so is His Messenger. So if you repent, it is better for you, but if you turn away, then know that you cannot escape Allah. And give tidings of a painful torment for those who disbelieve.} Allah says, this is a declaration, if from Allah and His Messenger}, and a preface warning to the people, ion the greatest day of Hajj}, the day of Sacrifice, the best and most apparent day of the Hajj rituals, during which the largest gathering confers. ithat Allah is free from (all) obligations to the Mushrik and so is His Messenger.} also free from all obligations to them. Allah next invites the idolaters to repent, iSo if you repent}, from the misguidance and Shirk you indulge in, of i'&} iit is better for you, but if you turn away}, and persist on your ways, ithen know that you cannot escape Allah} Rather, Allah is capable over you, and you are all in His grasp, under His power and will, iAnd give tidings of a painful torment for those who disbelieve}

earning them disgrace and affliction in this life and the torment of chains and barbed iron bars in the Hereafter. Al- Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "Abu Bakr sent me during that Hajj with those dispatched on the day of Sacrifice to declare in Mina that no Mushrik will be allowed to attend Hajj after that year, nor will a naked person be allowed to perform Tawaf." Humayd said, "The Prophet then sent 'Ali bin Abi Talib and commanded him to announce Bara'ah." Abu Hurayrah said, "Ali publicized Bara'ah with us to the gathering in Mina on the day of Sacrifice, declaring that no Mushrik shall perform Hajj after that year, nor shall a naked person perform Tawaf around the House." 1 11 Al-Bukhari also collected this Hadith the this narration of which, Abu Hurayrah said, "On the day of Nahr, Abu Bakr sent me along with other announcers to Mina to make a public announcement that 'No pagan is allowed to perform Hajj after this year, and no naked person is allowed to perform the Tawaf around the Ka'bah.' Abu Bakr was leading the people in that Hajj season, and in the year of The Farewell Hajf when the Prophet sg performed Hajj, no Mushrik performed Hajj." [2] This is the narration that Al-Bukhari recorded in the Book on Jihad. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported a narration from Abu Ja'far Muhammad bin 'Ali bin Al-Husayn who said, "When Bara'ah was revealed to Allah's Messenger jg, and he had sent Abu Bakr to oversee the Hajj rites for the people, he was asked, 'O Messenger of Allah!

Why not send this [message] to Abu Bakr?' So he said, "c bf J*&& 'f elt will not be accepted to have been from me if it is not from a man from my familyJ Then he called for 'Ali and said to him, \ IS] jp*.Jl ^lljl ^ dSlj jJuS> i Jfjt- olJli Vj t ^Ia]] JLju 15" N Ail [11 Fath Al-Bari 8 :168 [2[Fath Al-Bari 8:168.

374 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4i\ J JtJ; d 015 ^y iTake this section from the beginning of Bara'ah and proclaim to the people on the day of the Sacrifice while they are gathered at Mind that no disbeliever will enter Paradise, no idolator will be permitted to perform Hajj after the year, there will be no Tawaf while naked, and whoever has a covenant with Allah's Messenger, then it shall be valid until the time of its expiration .» 'Ali rode the camel of Allah's Messenger % named Al-'Adba' until he caught up with Abu Bakr in route. When Abu Bakr saw him he said, 'Are you here as a commander or a follower.' 'Ali replied, 'A follower.' They continued on. Abu Bakr lead the people in Hajj while the Arabs were camping in their normal locations from Jahiliyyah. On the day of Sacrifice, 'Ali bin Abi Talib stood and proclaimed, 'O people! No disbeliever will be admitted into Paradise, no idolator will be permitted to perform Hajj next year, there shall be no Tawaf while naked, and whoever has a covenant with Allah's Messenger gg, then it shall be valid until its time of expiration.' So no idolator performed Hajj after that year, Tawaf around the House while naked ceased. Then they returned to Allah's Messenger jg. So this was the declaration of innocence, whoever among the idolators had no treaty, then he had a treaty of peace for one year, if he had a particular treaty, then it was valid until its date of expiration. ",11 1\$ C2p£ !&£\$ ifcs j£fc; j* f zgzst & pi# 44. Except those of the Mushrikin with whom you have a treaty, and who have not subsequently failed you in aught, nor have supported anyone against you. So fulfill their treaty for them until the end of their term. Surely, Allah loves those who I 1 * At-Tabari 14:107 .This narration is not authentic because it is Mursal. The text of the saying of the Prophet jg is supported by a narration from Anas, recorded by At-Tirmidhi, under the Tafsir of this Surah. The remainder of the narration is supported by others. The scholars explain the mention of the Prophet's family to mean that such representation was necessary when changing a treaty.

375 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (4 - 5) (Part-10 have Taqwa.) Existing Peace Treaties remained valid until the End of Their Term This is an exception regulating the longest extent of time for those who have a general treaty - with out time mentioned - to four months. They would have four months to travel the lands in search of sanctuary for themselves wherever they wish. Those whose treaty mentioned a specific limited term, then the longest it would extend was to the point of its agreed upon termination date. Hadiths in this regard proceeded. So anyone who had a treaty with Allah's Messenger gg, it lasted until its specific termination date. However, those in this category were required to refrain from breaking the terms of the agreement with Muslims and from helping non-Muslims against Muslims. This is the type whose peace agreement with Muslims was carried out to its end. Allah encouraged honoring such peace treaties, saying. 41)1 6] 4 Surely, Allah loves those who have Taqwa} [9:4], who keep their promises. I#w* ^ ijbk %Htga lit a sj tsc yum ijwst ijs 4^ jt. 45. So when the Sacred Months have passed, then fight the Mushrikin wherever you find them, and capture them and besiege them, and lie in wait for them in each and every ambush. But if they repent and perform the Saldh, and give the Zakdh, then leave their way free. Verily, Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is the Ayah of the Sword Mujahid, 'Amr bin Shu'ayb, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Qat&adah, As-Suddi and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that

376 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the four months mentioned in this Ayah are the four-month grace period mentioned in the earlier Ayah ^So travel freely for four months throughout the land.) Allah said next, <&ii satp;^ 4So when the Sacred Months have passed...), meaning, TUpon the end of the four months during which We prohibited you from fighting the idolaters, and which is the grace period We gave them, then fight and kill the idolaters wherever you may find them.' Allah's statement next, i then fight the Mushrikin wherever you find them), means, on the earth in general, except for the Sacred Area, for Allah said, 4f*J^** f £>£ *1* (S*- Jifo vf) iAnd fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-Haram, unless they fight you there. But if they attack you, then fight them.)[2:191] Allah said here. iand capture them), executing some and keeping some prisoners, as iand besiege them, and lie in wait for them in each and every ambush), do not wait until you find them. Rather, seek and besiege them in their areas and forts, gather intelligence about them in the various roads and fairways so that what is made wide looks ever smaller to them. This way, they will have no choice, but to die or embrace Islam, i'U-j jjCc. iit 0} 'jlij tyLstj lj»l3 ujj^ m At-Jabari 14:136-137.

377 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (5 - 6) (Part-10) 4But if they repent and perform the Salah, and give the Zakdh, then leave their way free. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq used this and other honorable Ayat as proof for fighting those who refrained from paying the Zakdh. These Ayat allowed fighting people unless, and until, they embrace Islam and implement its rulings and obligations. Allah mentioned the most important aspects of Islam here, including what is less important. Surely, the highest elements of Islam after the Two Testimonials, are the prayer, which is the right of Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, then the Zakdh, which benefits the poor and needy. These are the most honorable acts that creatures perform, and this is why Allah often mentions the prayer and Zakdh together. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn 'Umar said that the Messenger of Allah said, <iil j jj lii vj ^i i if i ji- JJllf ji "/ have been commanded to fight the people until they testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, establish the prayer and pay the Zakdh. t 1 ' 1 This honorable Ayah (9:5) was called the Ayah of the Sword, about which Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said, "It abrogated every agreement of peace between the Prophet jg and any idolator, every treaty, and every term." Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas commented: "No idolator had any more treaty or promise of safety ever since Surah Bara'ah was revealed. The four months, in addition to, all peace treaties conducted before Bara'ah was revealed and announced had ended by the tenth of the month of Rabi' Al-Akhir." |2 > Aitl ^lii £_LLi . ' jSfLji J S pi 46. And if anyone of the Mushrikin seeks your protection then Fath Al-Bari 1 :95 and Muslim 1 :53. At-Tabari 14:133.

3ZE Tafsir Ibn Kathir grant him protection so that he may hear the Word of Allah (the Qur'an) and then escort him to where he can be secure, that is because they are men who know not.} Idolators are granted Safe Passage If They seek It Allah said to His Prophet, peace be upon him, iAnd if anyone of the Mushrikin}, whom you were commanded to fight and We allowed you their blood and property,' iX>&} i seeks your protection}, asked you for safe passage, then accept his request until he hears the Words of Allah, the Qur'an. Recite the Qur'an to him and mention a good part of the religion with which you establish Allah's proof against him, ig 2} iand then escort him to where he can be secure} and safe, until he goes back to his land, his home, and area of safety, fsA* i\$&m ithat is because they are men who know not.} The Ayah says, *We legislated giving such people safe passage so that they may learn about the religion of Allah, so that Allah's call will spread among His servants.' Ibn Abi

Najih narrated that Mujahid said that this Ayah, “Refers to someone who comes to you to hear what you say and what was revealed to you (O Muhammad). Therefore, he is safe until he comes to you, hears Allah’s Words and then proceeds to the safe area where he came from.” * The Messenger of Allah used to thereafter grant safe passage to those who came to him for guidance or to deliver a message. On the day of Hdaybiyyah, several emissaries from Quraysh came to him, such as Tjrwah bin Mas’Ckd, Mikraz bin Hafs, Suhayl bin ‘Amr and several others. They came mediating between him and the Quraysh pagans. They witnessed the iil At-Tabari 14:139.

great respect the Muslims had for the Prophet which astonished them, for they never before saw such respect for anyone, kings nor czars. They went back to their people and conveyed this news to them; this, among other reasons, was one reason that most of them accepted the guidance. When Musaylimah the Liar sent an emissary to the Messenger of Allah, he jg asked him, “Do you testify that Musaylimah is a messenger from Allah?” He said, “Yes.” The Messenger of Allah said, y\fe\&y \y&4 ^olj0Zftu \ftaijj ^\ft£===S\ilJ ift ftj ijjla.e- vL;>j ft y ft)\Mv> «/ would have cut off your head, if it was not that emissaries are not killed.^ l] That man, Ibn An-Nawwahah, was later beheaded when ‘Abdullah bin Mas’Ud was the governor of Al-Kufah. When it became known that he still testified that Musaylimah was a messenger from Allah, Ibn Mas’Qd summoned him and said to him, “You are not delivering a message now!” He commanded that Ibn An-Nawwahah be decapitated, may Allah curse him and deprive him of His mercy. In summary, those who come m Ibn Hisham 4:247.

380 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir from a land at war with Muslims to the area of Islam, delivering a message, for business transactions, to negotiate a peace treaty, to pay the Jizyah, to offer an end to hostilities, and so forth, and request safe passage from Muslim leaders or their deputies, should be granted safe passage, as long as they remain in Muslim areas, until they go back to their land and sanctuary. Hjj; jaxfx. jit it atk p yaa a ^t 47. How can there be a covenant with Allah and with His Messengerfor the Mushrikin except those with whom you made a covenant near Al-Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah)? So long as they are true to you, stand you true to them. Verily, Allah loves those who have Taqwa.\$ Affirming the Disavowel ofthe Idolators Allah mentions the wisdom in dissolving all obligations to the idolators and giving them a four month period of safety, after which they will meet the sharp sword wherever they are found. 4How can there be a covenant far the Mushrikin?^, a safe resort and refuge, while they persist in Shirk with Allah, and disbelief in Him and His Messenger, “.’ lit ^it iexcept those with whom you made a covenant near Al-Masjid Al-Haram\$, on the day of Hdaybiyyah. Allah said in another Ayah [concerning the day of Hdaybiyyah], M p. ol 6j& ilitj u^jt^ txr 4They are the ones who disbelieved and hindered you from Al- Masjid Al-Hardm and detained the sacrificial animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice .4 [48:25] Allah said next,

381Surah 9. At-Tawbah (7) (Part-10) iSo long as they are true to you, stand you true to them.}, if they keep the terms of the treaties you conducted with them, including peace between you and them for ten years, itthen stand you true to them. Verily, Allah loves those who have Taqwd The Messenger of Allah and the Muslims preserved the terms of the treaty with the people of Makkah from the month of Dhul-Qa’dah in the sixth year [of Hijrah], until the Quraysh broke it and helped their allies, Banu Bakr, against Khuza’ah, the allies of Allah’s Messenger jgg. Aided by the Quraysh, Banu Bakr killed some of Bani Khuza’ah in the Sacred Area! The Messenger of Allah sg led an invasion army in the month of

Ramadan, of the eighth year, and Allah opened the Sacred Area for him to rule over them, all thanks are due to Allah. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ freed the Quraysh who embraced Islam after they were overpowered and defeated. These numbered around two thousands, and they were referred to by the name 'Tulaqa' afterwards. Those among them who remained in disbelief and ran away from Allah's Messenger were sent promises of safe refuge for four months, during which they were allowed to move about freely. They included Safwan bin Umayyah, Ikrimah bin Abi Jahl and many others. Allah later on guided them to Islam, and they became excellent believers. Surely, Allah is worthy of all praise for all His actions and decrees. 48. How? When if you are overpowered by them, they regard not the ties, either of kinship, (III) or of covenant (Dhimmah)? With their mouths they please you, but their hearts are averse to you, and most of them are rebellious.} Allah encourages the believers to show enmity to the idolaters and to dissociate from them, affirming that they do not deserve to enjoy a covenant of peace, because of their Shirk in Allah and disbelief in Allah's Messenger ﷺ. If these disbelievers have a chance to defeat Muslims, they will cause

<But if they repent, perform the Salah...} \$—*» 4 oi 4^4 412. But if they violate their oaths after their covenant, and attack your religion with disapproval and criticism, then fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief- for surely, their oaths are nothing to them - so that they may stop (evil actions).} The Oaths of the Leaders of Disbelief mean nothing to Them Allah says, if the idolaters with whom you conducted peace treaties for an appointed term break ^their oaths meaning, terms of their treaties, and covenants iand attack your religion...} with disapproval and criticism, it is because of this that one who curses the Messenger, peace be upon him, or attacks the religion of Islam by way of criticism and disapproval, they are to be fought. This is why Allah said afterwards, itthen fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief - for surely, their oaths are nothing to them - so that they may stop.} so that they may refrain from the disbelief, rebellion and the transgression they indulge in. Qatadah and others said that the leaders of disbelief were Abu Jahl, Tjtbah and Shaybah, Umayyah bin Khalaf, and he went on to mention several others. Al-A'mash narrated from Zayd bin Wahb from Hudhayfah; "The people of this Ayah were never fought again."111 A similar statement was reported from 'Ali bin Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him. However, this Ayah is general, even though the specific reason behind revealing it was the idolaters of Quraysh. So this Ayah generally applies to At-Tabari 14:156.

them and others as well, Allah knows best. Al-Walid bin Muslim said that Safwan bin 'Amr narrated that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Jubayr bin Nufayr said that when Abu Bakr sent an army to Ash-Sham, he advised them, "You will find some people with shaved heads. Therefore, strike the swords upon the parts that contain the devil, for by Allah, it is better to me to kill one of these people than to kill seventy other men. This is because Allah said, itlien fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief Ibn Abi Hatim collected itj ggaj 'A<\ e&m ;jLg\$if 0 4iSj OuLla)' ^ j>\) -Ult jtkelj j&sW ,vij JIAJII^ y> 41 ir 4 <\$ &5 46 -£*21 fif -u^» *4r?j 46 j£ 41 4£; 413. Will you not fight a people who have violated their oaths and intended to expel the Messenger while they did attack you first? Do you fear them? Allah has more right that you should fear Him if you are believers.} m Ibn Abi Hatim 6 :1761

385 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (13 - 15) (Part-10 414. Fight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of a believing

people , 415. And remove the anger of their (believers') hearts. Allah accepts the repentance of whom He wills. Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.}

Encouragement to fight the Disbelievers, and some

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2256–2265]

Benefits of fighting them These Ayat encourage, direct and recommend fighting against the idolators who break the terms of their covenants, those who tried to expel the Messenger jg from Makkah. Allah said in other Ayat, Jr y -ay—* y 4And (remember) wheti the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expell you; they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the best of those who plot. (8:30], 3 'f£\j 4 ...and have driven out the Messenger and yourselves (from your homeland) because you believe in Allah your Lord!} [60:1], and, 4And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land.} (17:76) Allah's statement, 4while they did attack you first}, refers to the battle of Badr when the idolators marched to protect their caravan. When they knew that their caravan escaped safely, they still went ahead with their intent to fight Muslims out of arrogance, as we mentioned before. It was also said that these Ayat refer to the idolators breaking the peace agreement with Muslims and

386 Tafstr Ibt Kathfr aiding Bani Bakr, their allies, against Khuza'ah, the ally of the Messenger of Allah jg. This is why the Messenger of Allah marched to Makkah in the year of the victory, thus conquering it, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. Allah said, ^ oi&&\&) 4Do you fear them? Allah has more right that you should fear Him if you are believers .> Allah says here, "Do not fear idolaters, but fear Me instead, for I am worthy of being feared by the servants due to My might and punishment. In My Hand lies the matter; whatever I will occurs, and whatever I do not will does not occur." Allah next said, while ordering the believers and explaining the wisdom of ordaining Jihad against them, all the while able to destroy their enemies with a command from Him, •- * > '-&J ^ iFight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of a believing people.) This Ayah includes all believers, even though Mujahid, 'Ikrimah and As-Suddi said that it refers to Khuza'ah. 11 ' Concerning the believers, Allah said; iand remove the anger of their hearts), then 4Allah accepts the repentance of whom He wills), from His servants, i'fi \$s) iAllah is All-Knoioing), in what benefits His servants, [ii At-Tabari 14 :161

387 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (13 - 16) (Part-10 4All-Wise}, in His actions and statements, whether narrative or legislative. Allah does what He wills, decides what He wills, and He is the Just Who never wrongs any. Not even the weight of an atom of good or evil is ever neglected with Him, but rather, He compensates for it in this life and the Hereafter. 426. Do you think that you shall be left alone while Allah has not yet tested those among you who have striven hard and fought, and have not taken Walijah besides Allah and His Messenger, and the believers. Allah is well-acquainted with what you do.} Among the Wisdom of Jihad is to test the Muslims Allah said, 4^ 4Do you think}, O believers that We will leave you untested with matters that make apparent those who have pure, good intent from those who have false intent? This is why Allah said next, 'jj M jlj 0\$ tlj} Awhile Allah has not yet tested those among you who have striven hard and fought and have not taken Walijah besides Allah and His Messenger, and the believers...}, meaning, supporters and confidants. Rather, they are sincere for Allah

and His Messenger jg inwardly and outwardly. Allah also said; « 1\$& Saj v ft tssr. J %% J CS3 (\$&} 40c*riO iAlif-Ldm-Mim . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested. And We indeed tested those who were before them. And Allah will certainly make known those who are true, and will certainly make known those who are liars . . . } [29: 1-3],

j&j (£~t b^t 'f iii Jju Oj iLJ' ijli-jC J 4D0 you 1/rinfc that you will enter Paradise before Allah tests those of you who fought (in His cause) and (also) tests those who are patient?}[3:142], and, iijif u i:- £^&v&&S® Si®&& iAlldlt mil not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good}[3:179]. In summary, since Allah legislated Jihad for His servants, He explained that the wisdom behind doing so includes testing His servants, distinguishing between those who obey Him and those who disobey Him. Allah, the Exalted, is the All-Knower of what occurred, what will occur, and the true essence of what might occur had He decided it. Therefore, Allah knows everything before it occurs and how it will occur, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, nor a Lord except Him. Truly, there is none who can avert Allah's judgment and decision. iCf ^ <5 '4Pt ^ /So & Z \$ Ap & Sj lyjs ill iblj 4JJ* '•£=\$ u*j *jL^' A.«# .ifif il7. It is not for the Mushrikin, to maintain the Masjids of Allah, while they witness against themselves of disbelief. The works of such are in vain and in Fire shall they abide.} 418. The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Salah, and give Zakdh and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance.} It is not for Idolaters to maintain the Masjids of Allah. Allah says that it is not fitting that those who associate others with Allah in worship should maintain the Masjids of Allah that were built in His Name alone without partners. Those who read the Ayah, "Masjid AUdh", said that it refers to Al-Masjid Al-Haram, the most honored Masjid on the earth,

which was built, from the first day, for the purpose of worshipping Allah alone without partners. It was built by Khalil Ar-Rahman (the Prophet Ibrahim) peace be upon him. The idolaters do this while they themselves testify to their disbelief with their statements and actions. As-Suddi said, "If you ask a Christian, What is your religion?", He will tell you he is a Christian. If you ask a Jew about his religion, he will say he is a Jew, and the same for a Sabt and a Mushriki '"[11 4The works of such are in vain>, because of their Shirk, iand in Fire shall they abide.} Allah said in another Ayah, Hi VI Cj} ipjZA & vi ,oQi 4And why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Hardm, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those with Taqwd, but most of them know «ot.^[8:34J. Believers are the True Maintainers of the Masjids Allah said, ft&£ Z&yz'JJA Cl[} 4The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day.} Therefore, Allah testifies to the faith of those who maintain the Masjids. 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that 'Amr bin MaymQn Al-Awdi said, "I met the Companions of the Prophet igj and they were saying, The Masjids are the Houses of Allah on the earth. It is a promise from Allah that He is generous to those who visit Him in the Masjids.," Allah said next, m At-Tabari 14:165.

390 Tafsir Ibn Kathir {perform the Saldh}, one of the major acts of worship practiced by the body, {and give the Zakah}, which is the best act that benefits other people. {and fear none but Allah}, they fear only Allah, the Exalted, and none else, {It is they who are on true guidance.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, sff ft^Z ft £=Q} {The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day;} "He who singles out Allah (in

worship), has faith in the Last Day.” [And he said]; “He who believes in what Allah has revealed, {perform the Salah}, establishes the five daily prayers, {and fear none but Allah.}, worships Allah alone, {u.f~^ Si \j& ^ {it may be they who are on true guidance.} Allah says, It is they who are the successful ones in truth.’ Similarly, Allah said to His Prophet Lily &{*} {It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud}[17:79\.

Allah says here, ‘Your Lord (O Muhammad) shall grant you a station of praise, that is, the intercession (on the Day of Resurrection).’ Every ‘might’ in the Qur’an means ‘shall’.” ’fUj gtt ill \$ 4 ip: \$(J-P 4 IjPw If: £)•> jikcl j^~illj y>yj <-« -***-> t>jC£ Jil 5) Ijjl Ijj pi 419. Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims and the maintenance of Al-Masjid Al-Haram as equal to the worth of those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, and strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah? They are not equal before Allah. And Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers. 420. Those who believed and emigrated and strove hard and fought in Allah's cause with their wealth and their lives, are far higher in degree with Allah. They are the successful 421. Their Lord gives them glad tidings of mercy from Him, At-Tabari 14:167.

and His being pleased (with them), and of Gardens (Paradise) for them wherein are everlasting delights.} ill. They will dwell therein forever. Verily, with Allah is a great reward .} Providing Pilgrims with Water and maintaining the Sacred Masjid are not equal to Faith and Jihad In his Tafsir, Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas explained this Ayah : “The idolators said, ‘Maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram and providing water for pilgrims are better than embracing the faith and performing Jihad.’ They used to boast and show off among the people because they claimed, they were the people and maintainers of Al-Masjid Al-Haram. Allah mentioned their arrogance and rejection (of the faith), saying to *the people of Al-Haram’, who were idolators, indeed My Ayat used to be recited to you, but you used to turn back on your heels (denying them, and refusing to listen to them with hatred). In pride, talking evil about it (the Qur’an) by night.} (23:66-67]. They used to boast about being those who maintained the Sacred Sanctuary, italking about it by night}. They used to talk about this by night while shunning the Qur’an and the Prophet Allah declared that faith and Jihad with the Prophet are better than the idolators’ maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram and providing water for pilgrims. These actions - maintaining and serving Allah’s House - will not benefit them with Allah because they associate others with Him. Allah the Exalted said, ivJfA pjil -at' ju} iThey are not equal before Allah. And Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers.} those who claimed they are the maintainers of the House. Allah described them with injustice, on account of their Shirk,

393Sura}i 9. At-Taivbah (19 - 22) (Part-10) and thus, their maintaining the Masjid will not avail them.” ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This Ayah was revealed about Al-‘Abbas bin ‘Abdul-Muttalib, for when he was captured in the battle of Badr, he said, If you rushed before us to embrace Islam, perform Hijrah and Jihad, we were maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram, providing water for the pilgrims and setting the indebted free.’ Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, said, as 4Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims), until, iand Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers). Allah says, ‘All these actions were performed while committing Shirk, and I do not accept the {good deeds} that are performed while in a state of Shirk.’ ”*21 Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said, “Muslims came to Al-‘Abbas and his friends who were captured during the battle of

Badr and admonished them for their Shirk. Al-‘Abbas said, “By Allah! We used to maintain Al- Masjid Al-Haram, release the indebted, serve the House (or cover it, or maintain it) and provide water for pilgrims.’ Allah revealed this verse, 4Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims... There is a Hadith [from the Prophet about the Tafsir of this Ayah that we should mention. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that An-Nu‘man bin Bashir said that a man said, “I do not care if I do not perform an action after embracing Islam other than providing drinking water for pilgrims [who visit the Ka'bah at Makkah].” Another man said, “I do not care if I do not perform an action after embracing Islam other than maintaining Al- Masjid Al-Haram.” A third man said, “Jihad in the cause of 1,1 At-Jabari 14:170. | 21 At-Tabari 14:170. 131 At-Jabari 14:172.

Allah is more righteous than what you have said.” TJmaradmonished them, “Do not raise your voices next to the Minbarof the Messenger of Allah,” and as it was a Friday, he said, “but after we pray the Friday prayer, we will go to the Prophet mand ask him.” This verse was revealed, X}&gi iiL 4Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims and the maintenance ofAl-Masjid Al-Hardm}, until, 4\$ V} 4They are not equal before Allah. £ \$ fci/i •\$ \pL int, *^1 if &• 4 if^ 423 . O you who believe! Take not as supporters your fathers and your brothers if they prefer disbelief to belief. And whoever ofyou befriends them, then he is one of the wrongdoers.} 424. Say: If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your spouses, your kindred, the wealth that you have gained, the commerce in which you fear a decline, and the dwellings in which you delight are dearer to you than Allah and His Messenger, and striving hard and fighting in His cause, then wait until Allah brings about His decision (torment). And Allah guides not the people who are rebellious.}

The Prohibition of taking the Idolators as Supporters,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2265–2269]

even with Relatives Allah commands shunning the disbelievers, even if they are one’s parents or children, and prohibits taking them as supporters if they choose disbelief instead of faith. Allah warns, [il Muslim no. 1879.

jtj 'kk <y o>Ab! y-'-'S* ^ 4 ^W <sj? Z&b'A'j *-4 iYou will notfind any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even though they were theirfathers or their sons or their brothers or their kindred (people) . For such He has written (predetermined) faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with a Ruh (proof, light and true guidance)from Himself. And He will admit them to Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow) (58:221 Al-Hafiz Al-Bayhaqi recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Shawdhab said, “The father of Abu ‘Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah was repeatedly praising the idols to his son on the day of Badr, and Abu ‘Ubaydah kept avoiding him. When Al-Jarrah persisted, his son Abu ‘Ubaydah headed towards him and killed him. Allah revealed this Ayah in his case, Sll iYou will notfind any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger.')[58-22] Allah commanded His Messenger jg to warn those who prefer their family, relatives or tribe to Allah, His Messenger and Jihad in His cause. pAj & 4 iSay : If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your wives, your kindred, the wealth that you have gained>, amassed and collected. MX#2 4the commerce in which you fear a

decline, and the dwellings in which you delight, and prefer and love because they are comfortable and good. If hi Al-Bayhaqi 9 :27. This is a Mursal narration.

396 Tafsir ton Kathir all these things, 4 'At-jj& ilk (&=4[z^\) \$are dearer to you than Allah and His Messenger, and striving hard and fighting in His cause, then wait...) for what will befall you of Allah's punishment and torment. g; SXf_ Y ii(j <MMh7 Allah brings about His decision. And Allah guides not the people who are rebellious.) Imam Ahmad recorded that Zuhrah bin MaTaad said that his grandfather said, "We were with the Messenger of Allah while he was holding the hand of 'Umar bin Al-Khattab. "Umar said, *By Allah! You, O Messenger of Allah, are dearer to me than everything, except for myself.' The Messenger of Allah jg said, "None among you will attain faith until I become dearer to him than even himself.« 'Umar said, Verily, now, you are dearer to me than myself, by Allah!' The Messenger of Allah^ said, U oV l» "Now, O 'Umar/b"* 1 Al-Bukhari also collected this Hadith.™ Imam Ahmad and Abu Dawud (this is the version of Abu Dawud) recorded that Ibn 'Umar said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, <5>1 JaL« ..b/j fii I <— aLaJL Lj hi «If you transact in 'Iynah (a type of Riba) , follrnv the tails of cows (tilling the land), become content with agriculture and abandoned Jihad, Allah will send on you disgrace that He will not remove until, you return to your religion . »"*31 Ahmad 4 :336 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :532 Ahmad 2 :42 and Abu Dawud : 3462

^ js»£» ^ [f£%&-C££==ti1 > ><' ^c > -i t >r ^_44Lu ' '•J'' 4 > -<•> >y^i > *.f >s? ^jir^1ij ^^==6>.^1 ii' ^j\^___3'j ix'S^&plr&JJ Ti_ ^j p&s 4^^0'y ijii j£=vAi ^2^ • 1 »/> <'•<' 4^ H 9^ f>-> /*== Cj p^S \$? JS £ ££ i^jUp i 'j>»- J>t> oiijtff Jj& ^ d 4£ ii :KS^J' iT> \$5>2 * £^ *5 k » C #•{ < iJf/ <>™.,.,~»y >*- * 4#'-> <25. Truly, Allah has given you victory on many battlefields, and on the day of Hunayn (battle) when you re- joiced at your great —II number, but it availed you naught and the earth, vast as it is, was straitened far you, then you turned back in flight}. <26. Then Allah did send down His Sakinah (tranquillity) on His Messenger, and on the believers, and sent down farces (angels) which you saw not, and punished the disbelievers. Such is the recompense of disbelievers}. <27. Then after that Allah will accept the repentance of whom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} The Outcome of Victory by Way of the Unseen Aid Ibn Jurayj reported from Mujahid that this was the first Ayah of Bara'ah in which Allah, the Exalted, reminds the believers how He favored and blessed them by giving them victory in many battles with His Messenger Allah

mentioned that victoiy comes from Him, by His aid and decree, not because of their numbers or adequate supplies, whether the triumphs are few or many. On the day of Hunayn, the Muslims were proud because of their large number, which did not avail them in the least; they retreated and fled from battle. Only a few of them remained with the Messenger of Allah jg Allah then sent down His aid and support to His Messenger jg and the believers who remained with him, so that they were aware that victory is from Allah alone and through His aid, even if the victorious were few. Many a small group overcame a larger opposition by Allah's leave, and Allah is ever with those who are patient. We will explain this subject in detail below, Allah willing. The Battle of Hunayn

The battle of Hunayn occurred after the victoiy of Makkah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2269–2277]

in the month of Shawwal of the eighth year of Hijrah. After the Prophet m conquered Makkah and things settled, most of its people embraced Islam and he set them free. News came to the Messenger of Allah that the tribe of Hawazin were gathering their forces to fight him, under the command of Malik bin 'Awf An-Nadri, as well as, the entire tribe of Thaqif, the tribes of Banu Jusham, Banu Sa'd bin Bakr, a few people of Awza' from Banu Hilal and some people from Bani 'Amr bin 'Amir and 'Awf bin 'Amir. They brought their women, children, sheep and camels along, in addition to their armed forces and adequate supplies. The Messenger of Allah sg marched to meet them with the army that he brought to conquer Makkah, ten thousand from the Muhajirin, the Ansar and various Arab tribes. Along with them came the Tulaqa' numbering two thousand men. The Messenger $\wedge$ took them along to meet the enemy. The two armies met in Humayn, a valley between Makkah and At-Ta'if. The battle started in the early part of the morning, when the Huwazin forces, who were lying in ambush, descended on the valley when the Muslims entered. Muslims were suddenly struck by the ambush, the arrows descended on them and the swords struck them. The Huwazin commander ordered them to descend and attack the Muslims as one block, and when they did that, the Muslims retreated in haste, just as Allah described them. The Messenger of Allah $\wedge$ remained firm in

399 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (25 - 27) (Part-10) his position while riding his mule, Ash-Shahba'. He was leading his mule towards the enemy, while his uncle Al-'Abbas was holding its right-hand rope and (his cousin) Abu Sufyan bin Al-Harith bin 'Abdul-Muttalib was holding the left rope. They tried to hold the mule back so it would not run faster toward the enemy. Meanwhile, the Messenger of Allah hg was declaring his name aloud and saying, $\langle 4 \rangle$ i jp; uf «O servants of Allah! Come back to me! I am the Messenger of Allah!* He repeated these words, uf ol am the Prophet, not lying! I am the son of Abdul-Muttalib! $\wedge$ There remained between a hundred and eighty Companions with the Prophet hg . These included Abu Bakr, "Umar, Al-'Abbas, 'Ali, Al-Fadl bin 'Abbas, Abu Sufyan bin Al-Harith, Ayman the son of Umm Ayman and Usamah bin Zayd. There were many other Companions, may Allah be pleased with them. The Prophet hg commanded his uncle Al-'Abbas, whose voice was rather loud, to call at the top of his voice, "O Companions of the Samurah (tree)" referring to the Muhajirin and Ansar who gave their pledge under the tree during the pledge of Ridwan, not to run away and retreat. He also called, "O Companions of Surat Al-Baqarah." Upon hearing that, those heralded started saying, "Here we are! Here we are!" Muslims started returning in the direction of the Messenger of Allah hg . If the camel of one of them did not obey him (as the people were rushing to the other direction in flight) he would wear his shield and descend from his camel and rush to the side of the Messenger of Allah hg on foot. When a large crowd gathered around the Messenger of Allah hg , he commanded them to fight in sincerity and took a handful of sand and threw it in the faces of the disbelievers, after supplicating to Allah, t C*! 'jrf $\wedge$ •O Allah! Fulfill Your promise to me!* Then he threw that handful of sand which entered the eyes and mouth of all the disbelievers, thus distracting them from fighting, and they retreated in defeat. The Muslims pursued the enemy, killing

and capturing them. The rest of the Muslim army (returning to battle gradually) rejoined their positions and found many captured disbelieving soldiers kept tied before the Messenger of Allah hg . In the Two Sahihis, it is recorded that Shu'bah said that Abu Ishaq said that Al-Bara' bin 'Azib said to a man who asked him, O Abu 'Amarah! Did you run away during Hunayn and leave the Messenger of Allah hg ?" Al-Bara' said, "But the Messenger of Allah hg did not run away. Hawazin was a tribe proficient with

their arrows. When we met them we attacked their forces and they ran away in defeat. The Muslims started to worry about collecting the spoils of war and the Hawazin started shooting arrows at us, then the Muslims fled. I saw the Messenger of Allah ﷺ proclaiming, - while Abu Sufyan was holding the bridle of his white mule, 44¹⁴?* jit ui - j.ijs'j ^iji i;ft 0/ am the Prophet, not lying, I am the son of 'Abdul- Muttalib!¹⁴ This shows the great courage on behalf of the Prophet ﷺ in the midst of confusion, when his army ran away and left him behind. Yet, the Messenger remained on his mule, which is a slow animal, not suitable for fast battle moves or even escape. Yet, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was encouraging his mule to move forward towards the enemy announcing who he was, so that those among them who did not know who he was came to know him. May Allah's peace and blessings be on the Messenger until the Day of Resurrection. This indicates the tremendous trust in Allah and reliance upon Him, as well as, sure knowledge that He will give him victory, complete what He has sent him for and give prominence to his religion above all other religions. Allah said, ﷻ 'it jJ iThen Allah did send down His Sakinah on His Messenger>, He sent down tranquillity and reassurance to His Messenger, m Fath Al-Bari 6:81 and Muslim 3:1401. Most of what is mentioned in this section may be seen in these references.

'P' iand on the believers who remained with him, iand sent down forces which you saw not, \$ this refers to angels. Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir {At-Tabari} said that Al-Qasim narrated to them, that Al-Hasan bin 'Arafah said that Al- Mutamir bin Sulayman said from 'Awf bin Abi Jamllah Al- 'Arabi who said that he heard 'Abdur-Rahman, the freed slave of Ibn Barthan saying, "A man who participated in Hunayn with the idolaters narrated to me, When we met the Messenger of Allah and his Companions on the day of Hunayn, they did not remain in battle more than the time it takes to milk a sheep! When we defeated them, we pursued them until we ended at the rider of the white mule, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ . At that time, men with white handsome faces intercepted us and said: Disgraced be the faces! Go back. So we ran away, but they followed us. That was the end for us." 11 ' Ulah said, iThen after that Allah will accept the repentance ofwhom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.> Allah forgave the rest of Huwazin when they embraced Islam and went to the Prophet ﷺ , before he arrived at Makkah in the Ji'ranah area. This occurred twenty days after the battle of Hunayn. The Messenger gave them the choice between taking those who were prisoner or the war spoils they lost, and they chose the former. The Prophet ﷺ released six thousand prisoners to them, but divided the war spoils between the victors, such as some of the Tulaqa', so that their hearts would be inclined towards Islam. He gave each of them a hundred camels, and the same to Malik bin 'Awf An-Nasri whom he appointed chief of his people (Huwazin) as he was before. Malik bin 'Awf said a poem in which he praised the Messenger of Allah ﷺ for his generosity and extraordinary courage. 111 At-Tabari 14:186.

faA lEj& * l2* tp: <</i(\%\& l I' S.1 , V/* . . * < >5f •> <^ <f •*' * >? . - . • / Ail' 0| £>* Ail I n^lw 4*^ >-i> op *.iL^ a us#«&\%&£&& 'i \&s ff ;kj 0^ !>!*» <Sr s~≈J' Ih/ <^i\$^ ir, 4»^' cti r*J 428. O you who believe! Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram after this year; and ifyou fear poverty, Allah will enrich you ifHe wills, out ofHis bounty. Surely, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 429. Fight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, nor forbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture, until they pay the Jizyah with willing submission, andfeel themselves subdued.} Idolators are no longer allowed into Al-MasjidAl-Haram Allah

commands His believing servants, who are pure in religion and person, to expel the idolators who are filthy in the religious sense, from Al-Masjid Al-Haram. After the revelation of this Ayah, idolators were no longer allowed to go near the Masjid. This Ayah was revealed in the ninth year of Hijrah. The Messenger of Allah sent 'Ali in the company of Abu Bakr that year to publicize to the idolators that no Mushrik will be allowed to perform Hajj after that year, nor a naked person allowed to perform Tawaf around the House. Allah completed this decree, made it a legislative ruling, as well as, a fact of reality. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah commented on the Ayah, *Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram after this year* "Unless it was a servant or one of the people of Dhimmah." Imam Abu 'Amr Al-Awza'i said, "Umar bin 'Abdul-'Aziz wrote 111 'Abdur-Razzaq 2:271.

(to his governors) to prevent Jews and Christians from entering the Masjids of Muslims, and he followed his order with Allah's statement, *Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. 'Ata' said, "All of the Sacred Area [the Haram] is considered a Masjid, for Allah said, "So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) after this year."* This Ayah indicates that idolators are impure and that the believers are pure. In the Sahth is the following, *«The believer does not become impure. Allah said, if you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you, out of His bounty. Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, "The people said, 'Our markets will be closed, our commerce disrupted, and what we earned will vanish.' So Allah revealed this verse, and if you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you, out of His bounty from other resources, until, i...and feel themselves subdued.* This Ayah means, 'this will be your compensation for the 111 Fath Al-Bari3:150.

closed markets that you feared would result.' Therefore, Allah compensated them for the losses they incurred because they severed ties with idolators, by the Jizyah they earned from the People of the Book." 11 Similar statements were reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak and others. Allah said, *4Surely, Allah is All-Knowing}, in what benefits you, 4All-Wise}, in His orders and prohibitions, for He is All-Perfect in His actions and statements, All-Just in His creations and decisions, Blessed and Hallowed be He. This is why Allah compensated Muslims for their losses by the amount of Jizyah that they took from the people of Dhimmah. The Order to fight People of the Scriptures until They give the Jizyah Allah said, ii' Vj "3j Jit •£. o* +&\$ — LhjI 02 Ue. dtY-Jt 4fKS- 4Fighl against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, nor forbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture, until they pay the Jizyah with willing submission, and feel themselves subdued.* Therefore, when People of the Scriptures disbelieved in Muhammad jg, they had no beneficial faith in any Messenger or what the Messengers brought. Rather, they followed their religions because this conformed with their ideas, lusts and the ways of their forefathers, not because they are Allah's Law and 111 At-Tabari 14:197. 121 At-Tabari 14:193-196.

405 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (28 - 29) (Part-10) religion. Had they been true believers in their religions, that faith would have directed them to believe in Muhammad jg, because all Prophets gave the good news of Muhammad's advent and commanded them to obey and follow him Yet when he was sent, they disbelieved in him, even though he is the mightiest of all Messengers. Therefore, they do not follow the

religion of earlier Prophets because these religions came from Allah, but because these suit their desires and lusts. Therefore, their claimed faith in an earlier Prophet will not benefit them because they disbelieved in the master, the mightiest, the last and most perfect of all Prophets Hence Allah's statement, % \$j~jj u &££% yjii % jit y iFight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, norforbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture,} This honorable Ayah was revealed with the order to fight the People of the Book, after the pagans were defeated, the people entered Allah's religion in large numbers, and the Arabian Peninsula was secured under the Muslims' control. Allah commanded His Messenger gg to fight the People of the Scriptures, Jews and Christians, on the ninth year of Hijrah, and he prepared his army to fight the Romans and called the people to Jihad announcing his intent and destination. The Messenger jg sent his intent to various Arab areas around Al- Madlnah to gather forces, and he collected an army of thirty thousand. Some people from Al-Madlnah and some hypocrites, in and around it, lagged behind, for that year was a year of drought and intense heat. The Messenger of Allah jg marched, heading towards Ash-Sham to fight the Romans until he reached Tabuk, where he set camp for about twenty days next to its water resources. He then prayed to Allah for a decision and went back to Al-Madlnah because it was a hard year and the people were weak, as we will mention, Allah willing. Paying Jizyah is a Sign ofKufrand Disgrace Allah said,

4until they pay the Jizyah), if they do not choose to embrace Islam, 4with willing submission in defeat and subservience. iand feel themselves subdued.), disgraced, humiliated and belittled. Therefore, Muslims are not allowed to honor the people ofDhimmah or elevate them above Muslims, for they are miserable, disgraced and humiliated. Muslim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet j£5 said, jl JjJkiu j,>J pj bp »jZ?\\ tDo not initiate the Saldm to the Jews and Christians, and if you meet ami of them in a road, farce them to its narrowest alley.n' 1' This is why the Leader of the faithful "Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, demanded his well-known conditions be met by the Christians, these conditions that ensured their continued humiliation, degradation and disgrace. The scholars of Hadith narrated from 'Abdur-RahmSn bin Ghanm Al-Ash'ari that he said, "I recorded for 'Umar bin Al- Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, the terms of the treaty of peace he conducted with the Christians of Ash-Sham:

In the Name of Allah, Most Gracious, Most Merciful. This is a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2277–2284]

document to the servant of Allah Umar, the Leader of the faithful, from the Christians of such and such city. When you (Muslims) came to us we requested safety for ourselves, children, property and followers of our religion. We made a condition on ourselves that we will neither erect in our areas a monastery, church, or a sanctuary for a monk, nor restore any place of worship that needs restoration nor use any of them for the purpose of enmity against Muslims. We will not I 11 Muslim 4:1707.

407Surah 9. At-Tawbah (2d - 29) <Part-10> prevent any Muslim from resting in our churches whether they come by day or night, and we will open the doors (of our houses of worship] for the wayfarer and passerby. Those Muslims who come as guests, will enjoy boarding and food for three days. We will not allow a spy against Muslims into our churches and homes or hide deceit [or betrayal] against Muslims.

We will not teach our children the Qur'an, publicize practices of Shirk, invite anyone to Shirk or prevent any of our fellows from embracing Islam, if they choose to do so. We will respect Muslims, move from the places we sit in if they choose to sit in them. We will not imitate their clothing, caps, turbans, sandals, hairstyles, speech, nicknames and title names, or ride on saddles, hang swords on the shoulders, collect weapons of any kind or carry these weapons. We will not engrave our stamps in Arabic, or sell liquor. We will have the front of our hair cut, wear our customary clothes wherever we are, wear belts around our waist, refrain from erecting crosses on the outside of our churches and demonstrating them and our books in public in Muslim fairways and markets. We will not sound the bells in our churches, except discretely, or raise our voices while reciting our holy books inside our churches in the presence of Muslims, nor raise our voices [with prayer] at our funerals, or light torches in funeral processions in the fairways of Muslims, or their markets. We will not bury our dead next to Muslim dead, or buy servants who were captured by Muslims. We will be guides for Muslims and refrain from breaching their privacy in their homes.' When I gave this document to 'Umar, he added to it, *We will not beat any Muslim. These are the conditions that we set against ourselves and followers of our religion in return for safety and protection. If we break any of these promises that we set for your benefit against ourselves, then our Dhimmah (promise of protection) is broken and you are allowed to do with us what you are allowed of people of defiance and rebellion.'" 33 via # 53 J4Eis 'J3 « I #&& Luy1 |i] Al-Muhalld, by Ibn Hazm 7:346

(Jjj Uj A fl&& ?&ZE 4E;sE4^EE ^n H v« 430. And the Jews say: "Uzayr (Ezra) is the son of Allah" and the Christians say: "The Messiah is the son of Allah." That is their saying with their mouths, resembling the saying of those who disbelieved aforetime. May Allah fight them, how they are deluded away from the truth!) 431. They (Jews and Christians) took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah, and (they also took as their Lord) the Messiah, son of Maryam, while they were commanded to worship none but One God, none has the right to be worshipped but He. Praise and hallowed be He above what they associate (with Him)."} Fighting the Jews and Christians is legislated because They are Idolaters and Disbelievers Allah the Exalted encourages the believers to fight the polytheists, disbelieving Jews and Christians, who uttered this terrible statement and utter lies against Allah, the Exalted. As for the Jews, they claimed that 'Uzayr was the son of God, Allah is free of what they attribute to Him. As for the misguidance of Christians over Isa, it is obvious. This is why Allah declared both groups to be liars, it is) t >-\$5 ^Ji/} iThat is their saying with their mouths}, but they have no proof that supports their claim, other than lies and fabrications, 4<z&& } ^.resembling}, imitating, 445 of &} 4the saying of those who disbelieved aforetime.} They imitate the previous nations who fell into misguidance just as Jews and Christians did, 453 J4&Z} 4may Allah fight them}, Ibn 'Abbas said, "May Allah curse them."

SiiraJt 9. At-Tawbah (30 - 31) (Part-10, 409 }how they are deluded away from the truth!} how they deviate from truth, when it is apparent, exchanging it for misguidance. Allah said next, ifZp jt A iThey took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah, and the Messiah, son of Maryam} [9:31]. Imam Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari recorded a Hadith via several chains of narration, from 'Adi bin Hatim, may Allah be pleased with him, who became Christian during the time of Jdhiliyyah. When the call of the Messenger of Allah jg reached his area, 'Adi ran away to Ash-Sham, and his sister and several of his people were captured. The Messenger of Allah jg freed his sister and

gave her gifts. So she went to her brother and encouraged him to become Muslim and to go to the Messenger of Allah jg. ‘Adi, who was one of the chiefs of his people (the tribe of Tal) and whose father, Hatim At-Ta’i, was known for his generosity, went to Al-Madlnah. When the people announced his arrival, ‘Adi went to the Messenger of Allah jg wearing a silver cross around his neck. The Messenger of Allah jg recited this Ayah; iThey took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah}. ‘Adi commented, “I said, They did not worship them.” The Prophet jg said, «Yes they did. They (rabbis and monks) prohibited the allowed for them (Christians and Jews) and allowed the prohibited, and they obeyed them. This is how they worshipped them .» The Messenger of Allahg said to ‘Adi, U ?«S>i bib. JL: : jli oi nj Jjj pjC^ si : jii;M

J) Ur (Mm worship except Him. yMU*& ^ ^ @wwf u'Jl'T.w.^raN,—<Jv““““ ,^ tt , ..»« >1 >' &&*****>*) „ *~«££,t•mv***** m^ v^ |n1 _jt rLo<\$S-rh~ ,'£ extinguish Allah s Light i" , '<£ ¥•'ji^L. \j,/i\jL& wif/i tfieir mouths, but rry^~J 11^ wm not allow ex- cept that His Light '~ ^ •• <?'- should be perfected even though the disbelievers J*H\|cs£^'&-'ek^^4='<^r“ hate (it).} „ f . .;XT7?r>J <^tr-f <33. It is He Who has senf His Messenger with 1^,1Vt^A^j guidance and the reli- ^ ~ v •I“^'--' *>s“\ '-* gion o/ truth, to wafce it frp £> 4SI0H ial^=> superior over all reli- = " ~ " gions even though the idolators hate (it).} People of the Scriptures try to extinguish the Light of Islam Allah says, the disbelieving idolators and People of the Scriptures want to, 4# jy \& {extinguish the Light of Allah}. They try through argument and lies to extinguish the guidance and religion of truth that the Messenger of Allah W, was sent with. Their example is the example of he who wants to extinguish the light of the sun or the moon by blowing at them! Indeed, such a personmU never accomplish what he sought. Likewise, the light of what the

Messenger ^ was sent with will certainly shine and spread. Allah replied to the idolators’ desire and hope, jij J iil Ai/o/i w»7/ not allow except that His Light should be perfected even though the disbelievers (Kafirun) hate (it)} [9 :32], [Linguistincally] a Kafir is the person who covers something. For instance, night is called Kafiran [covering] because it covers things [with darkness]. The farmer is called Kafiran, because he covers seeds in the ground. Allah said in an Ayah, i’AC jt&rc c#} ithereof the growth is pleasing to the [Kujfdr] tillers}[57:20], Islam is the Religion That will dominate over all Other Religions Allah said next, Cfi;j J—jii y>} ilt is He Who has sent His Messenger with guidance and the religion oftruth.} ‘Guidance’ refers to the true narrations, beneficial faith and true religion that the Messenger came with, ‘religion of truth’ refers to the righteous, legal deeds that bring about benefit in this life and the Hereafter. ito make it (Islam) superior over all religions} It is recorded in the Sahth that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, ^ ^ ‘ J Sji oJ» «Allah made the eastern and western parts of the earth draw nearfar me [to see], and the rule ofmy Ummah will extend as far as I Imam Ahmad recorded from Tamlm Ad-Dari that he said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah saying, HI Muslim 4:2215.

iGsi vj&^ *» &-^ •\$'S u ^ ft i.1 ijj f^X * >-& ^ '>•> ‘^ aThis matter (Islam) will keep spreading as far as the «« dax, reach , until Allah will not leave a house made of mud or hair but will make this religion enter it, while bringing might to a mighty person (a Muslim) and humiliation to a disgraced person \who rejects Islam). Might with which AMh elevates Islam (and its people) and disgrace with which Allali humiliates disbelief (and its people)J Tamim Ad-Dari [who was a Christian sav “I have come to know the meaning of this Hadith in my oJn people Those who became Muslims among them acquired

goodness, honor and might. Disgrace, humiliation and Jizyah befell those who remained disbelievers. } 434 O you who believe! Verily, there are many of the Alfoar (rabbis) and the Ruhban (monks) who devour the wealth of mankind in falsehood, and hinder (them) from the way of Allah. And those who hoard up gold and silver and spend them not in the way of Allah, announce unto them a painful torment. } 435 On the Day when that will be heated in the fire of Hell and with it will be branded their foreheads, their backs, (and it will be said unto them:) This is the treasure which you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste of what you used to hoard." }

Warning against Corrupt Scholars and Misguided

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2284–2346]

Worshippers As-Suddi said that the Ahbdr are Jewish rabbis, while the I1 ! Ahmad 4 :103 .

They sell the religion in return for worldly gains, using their positions and status among people to illegally devour their property. For instance, the Jews were respected by the people of Jahiliyyah and collected gifts, taxes and presents from them. When Allah sent His Messenger sg, the Jews persisted in their misguidance, disbelief and rebellion, hoping to keep their status and position. However, Allah extinguished all this and took it away from them with the light of Prophethood and instead gave them disgrace and degradation, and they incurred the anger of Allah, the Exalted. Allah said next, 4and hinder (them) from the way of Allah.} Therefore, they illegally devour people's property and hinder them from following the truth. They also confuse truth with falsehood and pretend before their ignorant followers that they call to righteousness. The true reality is that they call to the Fire and will not find any helpers on the Day of Resurrection. Torment of Those Who hoard Gold and Silver Allah said, iAnd those who hoard [Kanz] gold and silver and spend them not in the way of Allah, announce unto them a painful torment.} [9 :34). This is the third category of leaders, for people rely on their scholars, worshippers and the wealthy among them. When these categories of people become corrupt, the society in general becomes corrupt. Ibn Al-Mubarak once said, "What corrupted the religion, except kings and wicked Ahbar and Ruhban." As for Kanz, it refers to the wealth on which Zakah has not been paid, according to Malik, who narrated this from 'Abdullah bin Dinar from Ibn 'Umar. 111 Al-Bukhari recorded that Az-Zuhri said that Khalid bin Aslam said that 'Abdullah IM Al'Muwatta, 1 :256

bin 'Umar said, "This was before Zakah was ordained. When Zakah was ordained, Allah made it a cleanser for wealth."111 "Umar bin 'Abdul-'Aziz and Irak bin Malik said that this Ayah was abrogated by Allah's statement, y\ iTake Sadaqah (alms) from their wealthy There are many Hadiths that admonish hoarding gold and silver. We will mention here some of these Hadiths. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded a Hadlth from 'Ali about Allah's statement, iAtid those who hoard up gold and silver... } 'Ali said that the Prophet jg said, L: waJLU U b uWoe to gold! Woe to silver .» He repeated this statement thrice, and this Hadlth was hard on the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg, who said, "What type of wealth should we use?" Umar said, "I will find out for you," and he asked, "O Allah's Messenger! Your statement was hard for your Companions. They asked, What wealth should we use?" The Prophet jg answered, "Jr;? cji* | CLlJo «A remembering tongue, an appreciative heart and a wife that helps one of you implement his religion.^ Allah's statement, ^ rrp rJ £ 4^ <Oh the Day when that will be heated in the fire of Hell and with it will be branded their foreheads, their flanks, and their backs, (and it will be

said unto them) “This is the treasure FathAl-Bari 8:175. ‘Abdur-Razzaq 2:263. There is a Hadlth recorded by At-Tirmidhi no. 3094, and others with similar meaning.

which you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste ofwhat you used to hoard.”} These words will be said to them as a way of admonishing, criticizing and mocking them. Allah also said; iTheti pour over his head the torment of boiling water. "Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous!"} [44:48-49]. There is a saying that goes, “He who covets a thing and prefers it to Allah’s obedience, will be punished with it.” Because hoarding money was better to these people than Allah’s pleasure, they were punished with it. For instance, Abu Lahab, may Allah curse him, was especially active in defying the Messenger of Allah and his wife was helping him in this regard. Therefore, on the Day of Resurrection, she will help in punishing him, for there will be a twisted rope of palm fiber on her neck. She will be gathering wood from the Fire and throwing it on him so that his torment is made harder by the hand of someone whom he used to care for in this life. Likewise, money was precious to those who hoarded it in this life. Therefore, money will produce the worst harm for them in the Hereafter, when it will be heated in the Fire of Jahannam, whose heat is quiet sufficient, and their forehead, sides and back will be branded with it. Imam Abu JaTar Ibn Jarir recorded that Thawban said that the Messenger of Allah jgused to declare, Jilij -Jyjj iloil ’*} jli \’fs IjlL h) oi aLaL JljJ fj iLul ’kS’j, ^jjl ii’fs ui :jfti ?aEJ{ li -=* J>S~- Lf "Whoever leaves a treasure behind (on which he did not pay the Zakdlt), then on the Day of Resurrection his wealth will be made like a bald-headed poisonous male snake with two black spots over the eyes . The snake will follow him, and he will say, Woe to you! Who are you?’ The snake will say, 7 am your treasure that you left behind,' and will keep following him until the man gives it his hand; the snake will devour it and then

418 Tafsir Tbn Kathfr devour his whole body .» Ibn Hibban also collected this Hadith in his Sahih. Part of this Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahihs from Abu Hurayrah. 111 In his Sahih, Muslim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said, tjU ja iiUsli jji ^ ^ sl*j ^ it 'i> o5 iS**- tji •jliJi JI fy £*ii Js ii[SLi ^ •Even/ man who does not pay the Zakdh due on his money, then on the Day of Resurrection, his side, forehead and back will be branded with rods made offire on a Day the length of which is fifty thousand years, until when the servants will be judged; that man will be shown his destination, either to Paradise or the Fire.»|2i In the Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Zayd bin Wahb said, “I passed by Abu Dharr in the area of Rabadhah and asked him, What made you reside in this area?’ He said, We were in Ash-Sham when I recited this Ayah, rAr^» S’if* j Wyt-t ^And those who hoard up gold and silver and spend them not in the way ofAllah, announce unto them a painfiil torment. Mu’awiyah said, This Ayah is not about us, it is only about the People of the Book.’ So I (Abu Dharr) said, ‘Rather, it is about us and them.” 4 £*^ ‘U \M y, !A£i 55 fill cytf Yf- y J&’S £ 41 3 life* J32&* nr 436. Verily, the number ofmonths with Allah is twelve months !*• At-Tabari 6:363, Ibn Hibban: 803, Ibn Khuzaymah: 2255 and Al- Bukhari : 4659 I2 * Muslim 2 :682 131 FathAl-Bari 8:173.

419Surah 9. At-Tawbah (35 - 36) (Part-10) (in a year), so was it ordained by Allah on the Day when He created the heavens and the earth; ofthemfour are sacred. That is the right religion, so wrong not yourselves therein, and fight against the Mushrikin idolaters collectively as they fight against you collectively. But know that Allah is with those who have Taqwa.\$ The Year consists ofTwelve Months Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Bakrah said that the Prophet said in a speech during his Hajj, j-s- ell <

—!i oijiiJi 4ii jL - ^y; jj jujji aj vU &*ji jij ji ijii £•& iyj~ lirj! iju i^i, Ai^jj 4,1 : Idi €?Ili tM5 : d\i fS ^jj|
 ^ P- ^ :Jli wI^ v. «jl jYi vl-S—i <jj| : LU «?lju ; Jlj 4,1 :Ui «?lii ji; £{• :Jli r * tJu :bli G :jg <_i . Lli : Jli
 <«_! jSj *;1 Udi^ c-SL-i jj •Ji “The division of time has turned to its original form which was current
 when Allah created the heavens and the earth. The year is of twelve months, out of which four months
 are sacred: Three are in succession Dhiil-Qa'dah, Dhul-Hijjah and Muharram, and (the fourth is) Rajab
 of (the tribe of) Mudar which comes between Jumada (Ath-Thaniyah) and Sha'bdn.” The Prophet then
 asked, “What is the day today?” We said, “Allah and His Messenger know better. He kept quiet until
 we thought that he might give that day another name. He said isn't it the day of Nahr?” We replied,
 “Yes.” He further asked, “Which month is this?” We again said, “Allah and His Messenger know
 better,” and he kept quiet and made us think that he might give it another name. Then he said, zlsn't it
 the month of Dhul-Hijjah?” We replied, “Yes.” He asked, iWhat town is this?” We said, “Allah and His
 Messenger know better,” and he kept quiet until we thought that he might change its name. He asked,
 *Isn't

this the (Sacred) Tcrwn?» We said, “Yes.” He said, - ju ojM i\ ^ jijfc^ »iii ^ ili ^jb iff ?vLit; > iff 4-iiij 4-
 A: 'A> : N ^ J J*b Vi^' r^i a Verily! Your blood, property and honor are sacred to one another like the
 sanctity of this day of yours, in this month of yours and in this city of yours. Verily, you will meet your
 Lord and He will question you about your actions. Behold! Do not revert to misguidance after me by
 striking the necks of one another. Have I conveyed? It is incumbent upon those who are present to
 inform those who are absent, because those who are absent might comprehend (what I have said) better
 than some xoho are present .n*’ 1 Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this HadithP In a small book
 collected by Shaykh ‘Alam ad-Din As- Sakhawi, entitled, Al-Mashhdr fi Asma ’ Al-Ayam wash-Shuhur,
 he mentioned that Muharram is so named because it is a sacred month. To me, it was so named to
 emphasize its sacredness. This is because the Arabs would switch it around. One year they would say it
 was a sacred month, the following year they would say that it was not. The author said, “...and Safar is
 so named because they used to leave their homes during that month for fighting and traveling. When
 saying ‘Safvd a place, it means to leave it... RabT Al-Awwal is called that because they used to do
 Irtibd’ in it, that is to maintain one’s property... and Rabi' Al-Akhir, was so named for the same reasons.
 Jumada is called that because the water would dry up (Jamud) then....They say Jumada Al-Uwla and
 Al- Awwal, or Jumada Al-Akhar or Al-Akhirah. Rajab comes from Tarfib, meaning to honor. Shaban
 because the tribes would separate and return to their homes. Ramadan was so named because of the
 severity of the Ramda’ - that is - the heat, and they say that the branch Ramadat when it is thirsty...And
 the 111 Ahmad 5:37. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :175 , 6 :338 and 10:10 and Muslim 3 :1305

saying that it is a Name of Allah is a mistake, for there is no proof or support for that...” The Sacred
 Months Allah said, iof them four are sacred The Arabs used to consider these months sacred during the
 time of JahUiyyah, except for a group of them called Al-Basl, who held eight months of the year to be
 sacred as way of exaggeration in religion. The Prophet sg said, •jLOj “Three are in succession; Dhul-
 Qa'dah, Dhtil-Hijjah and Multarram, and (the fourth is) Rajah [of (the tribe of) Mudar which comes
 between Jumada (Ath-Thdni)] and Sha'bdm.

The Prophet jg said “Rajab ofMudar” to attest to the custom of Mudar, in saying that Rajab is the month
 that is between Jumada and ShaTaan, not as the tribe of Rabi'ah thought, that it is between ShaTaan and

Shawwal, which is Ramadan in the present calendar. The four Sacred Months were made four, three in succession and one alone, so that the Hajj and 'Umrah are performed with ease. Dhul-Qa'dah, the month before the Hajj month, was made sacred because they refrained from fighting during that month. Dhul-Hijjah, the next month, was made sacred because it is the month of Hajj, during which they performed Hajj rituals. Muharram, which comes next, was made sacred so that they are able to go back to their areas in safety [after performing Hajj]. Rajab, in the middle of the lunar year, was made sacred so that those coming from the farthest areas of Arabia are able to perform 'Umrah and visit the House and then go back to their areas safely. Allah said next, "That is the right religion that is the Straight Law, requiring implementing Allah's order concerning the months that He made sacred and their true count as it was originally written by

Allah. Allah said, "It is wrong not yourselves therein) during these Sacred Months, for sin in them is worse than sin in other months. Likewise, sins in the Sacred City are written multiplied, and whoever inclines to evil actions therein (in Makkah) or to do wrong, him We shall cause to taste from a painful torment [22:25]. Similarly, sin in general is worse during the Sacred Months 'Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, Allah's statement, "Verily, the number of months with Allah...," is connected to "so wrong not yourselves therein), "In all (twelve) months. Allah then chose four out of these months and made them sacred, emphasizing their sanctity, making sinning in them greater, in addition to, multiplying rewards of righteous deeds during them." Qatadah said about Allah's statement, "so wrong not yourselves therein), "Injustice during the Sacred Months is worse and graver than injustice in other months. Verily, injustice is always wrong, but Allah makes things graver than others as He will." He also said, "Allah has chosen some of His creation above others. He chose Messengers from angels and from men. He also chose His Speech above all speech, the Masjid above other areas of the earth, Ramadan and the Sacred Months above all months, Friday above the other days and Laylatul-Qadr (The Night of Decree) above all nights. Therefore, sanctify what Allah has sanctified, for doing so is the practice of people of understanding and comprehension." in At-Tabari 14 :238

423 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (36) (Part-10) Fighting in the Sacred Months Allah said, "and fight against the idolators collectively, all of you, as they fight against you collectively.", all of them, "But know that Allah is with those who have Taqwa, and know that initiating battle during the Sacred Months is forbidden. Allah said in other Ayat, "O you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of the symbols of Allah, nor of the sacred month." (5:2), "The Sacred Month is for the Sacred Month, and for the prohibited things, there is the law of equality (Qisas). Then whoever transgresses the prohibition against you, you transgress likewise against him" [2:194], and, "Then when the Sacred Months have passed, kill the idolators..." (9:5). As for Allah's statement, "And fight against the idolators collectively as they fight against you collectively", it includes permission for the believers to fight the idolators in the Sacred Month, if the idolators initiate hostilities therein. Allah said in other Ayat,

424 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir J (ggaa&s 'Mr sai'Su j-4^1EJk^5 ;SJdsi J^iijCi -*»J^ijfJy J L*_jijll_lj ll_jtL'jjc-^k==4X^j i ^ ia, ' -I - Jv^" *»J *J. >-?>/< » it |L>—A ij/Alot^T^j tjt =>,'yjf ^Ajjiipfy—3^ ' »*-^52^ ^ • © iJ^5r»^J^<^^^==>J ^4Tlw Sacred Month is for the Sacred Month, and for the prohibited

things, there is the law of equality (Qisas)} [2:194], and, m "iffy p* 4 t, &Z & ip>M \$And fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al- Hardrn, unless they (first) fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them> [2:191]. As for the Messenger of Allah 36 laying siege to At-Ta'if until the Sacred Month started, it was a continuation of the battle against Hawazin and their allies from Thaqif. They started the fighting and gathered then- men for the purpose of conducting war. The Messenger of Allah 3g marched to meet them and when they took refuge in At-Ta'if, the Prophet jg laid siege to them so that they descend from their forts, but they inflicted casualties on Muslims. The siege continued for about forty days, during which a Sacred Month began, and the siege continued for several days in that month. The Messenger jg broke the siege and went back (to Makkah). So fighting that carries over into it [the Sacred Month] is not the same as initiating warfare during it, Allah knows best. %%% ifc £T <<s 4 i<£ 3&-JI 4 ifj-ii 't ii[] > i ^ pj^- !* lit pj»- U li.

437. The postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief: thereby the disbelievers are led astray, for they make it lawful one year and forbid it another year in order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah, and make such forbidden ones lawful. The evil of their deeds is made fair-seeming to them. And Allah guides not the people who disbelieve.) Admonishing the Preference of Opinion in a Religious Matter Allah admonishes the idolators for choosing their wicked opinions over Allah's Law. They changed Allah's legislation based upon their vain desires, allowing what Allah prohibited and prohibiting what Allah allowed. They thought that three consecutive sacred months were rather long for them to remain without fighting, for they were full of anger and rage. This is why before Islam they innovated a change in the Sacred Month of Muharram, delaying it to the month of Safar. Therefore, they allowed fighting in the Sacred Month and made the non-sacred month sacred, to make the Sacred Months in a year four, as Allah decided! 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4>^=iK 4 iThe postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief}, "Junadah bin 'Awf bin Umayyah Al-Kinani, known as Abu Thumamah, used to attend the Hajj season every year and declare, 'Abu Thumamah is never rejected nor refuted!,' and he used to treat Safar as sacred for people one year [and un-sanctify Muharram] and treat Muharram as sacred another year [and un-sanctify Safar in that year]. This is why Allah said, 4 £2)^ 477ie postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief.} Allah says, They allow Muharram one year and make it sacred

another year." ' Al-'Awfi narrated a similar statement from Ibn 'Abbas.¹² ' Layth bin Abi Sulaym narrated that Mujahid said, "There was a man from Bani Kinanah who would attend the Hajj season every year riding his donkey. He would proclaim, 'O people! I am never rejected, denied or refuted in what I say. We made this coming Muharram sacred, and Safar not!' The following year he would come again and declare the same words then say, *We made this coming Safar sacred and delayed Muharram (revoked its sanctity).' This is the meaning of Allah's statement, iin order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah), to four months. Allah says, They allow what Allah disallowed by delaying the Sacred Month." 1'3 ' The idolators used to allow Muharram one year and sanctify Safar in its place. They would continue the months of the year according to their normal count and names. The next year they would sanctify Muharram and continue the year, \$afar, Rabi', until the end of the year. \$They make it lawful one year and forbid it another year in order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah, and make such forbidden ones lawful.) Therefore, they would still sanctify four

months every year, but would one year sanctify the third from the three consecutive Sacred Months, Muharram, and postpone and delay it another year to Safar. In his book of Sirah, Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq presented a very useful beneficial discussion on this matter. He said; “The first to start the practice of overlooking the sanctity of months for the Arabs, thus allowing what Allah sanctified of them and sanctifying what Allah allowed of them, was “Al- Qalammas”. He was Hudhayfah bin ‘Abd Fuqaym bin ‘Adi bin At-Tabari 14:245. ' At-Tabari 14:246. ' At-Tabari 14:246.

427 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (37) (Part-10 ‘Amr bin Thalabah bin Al-Harith bin Malik bin Kinanah bin Khuzaymah bin Mudrikah bin Ilyas bin Mudar bin Nizar bin Ma'dd bin ‘Adnan. His son ‘Abbad maintained this practice, then after him his son Qala’ bin ‘Abbad did the same, Then his son Umayyah bin Qala', then his son ‘Awf bin Umayyah, then his son Abu Thumamah Junadah bin ‘Awf. He was the last one of his sons (to continue this practice) before Islam. The Arabs used to gather around him when Haft finished, and he would stand and give them a speech in which he sanctifies Rajab, Dhul-Qa’dah and Dhul-Hijjah. He would defer the sanctity of Muharram to Safar one year and uphold its sanctity another year, so as to appear upholding the number (of Sacred Months) Allah made sacred. Therefore, he would allow what Allah prohibited and prohibit what Allah allowed. ,<11 Allah knows best. Ijgfl JI ZZ& ft^ 4 i >j3U H\$ C IP'. 'll -£jgi\ 4 TgSt ££ qlf ^ iLiCP \j^ 438. O you who believe! What is the matter with you, that when you are asked to march forth in the cause of Allah, you cling heavily to the earth? Are you pleased with the life of this world rather than the Hereafter? But little is the enjoyment of the life of this world compared to the Hereafter. <39. If you march not forth, He will punish you with a painful torment and will replace you by another people; and you cannot harm Him at all, and Allah is able to do all things. Admonishing clinging to Life rather than rushing to perform Jihad Allah admonishes those who lagged behind the Messenger of Allah in the battle of Tabuk, at a time when fruits were ripe and shades tempting in the intense and terrible heat, ijt^ 4 £j Xi lij# U \£X I 1 * Ibn Hisham 1 :45.

428 Tafsir Ibn Kalhir you who believe! What is the matter with you, that when you are asked to march forth in the cause of Allah}, if you are called to perform Jihad in the cause of Allah, ji iyou cling heavily to the earth?}, reclining to remain in peace, shade and ripe fruits. iAre you pleased with the life of this world rather than the Hereafter?}, why do you do this, is it because you prefer this life instead of the Hereafter? Allah next diminishes the eagerness for this worldly life and increases it for the Hereafter, <But little is the enjoyment of the life of this world compared to the Hereafter.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Mustawrid, a member of Bani Fihri, said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, (*-; fQ* ‘pi* tj j ^ (lijJl The life of this world, compared to the Hereafter, is just like when one of you dips his finger in the sea, let him contemplate how much of it his finger would carry. The Prophet jg pointed with his index finger. 111 Muslim collected this HadithP Ath-Thawri narrated that Al- A'mash said about the Ayah, ^4 —4* 4 ^4^* \j>} }But little is the enjoyment of the life of this world compared to the Hereafter.} “What compares to the provision a traveler takes.” ‘Abdul- ‘Aziz bin Abi Hazim narrated that his father said, “When Ahmad 4:228. Muslim 4 :2193

‘Abdul-'Aziz bin Marwan was dying he said, *Bring the shroud I will be covered with so that I inspect it.’ When it was placed before him, he looked at it and said, Is this what I will end up with from this life?’ He then turned his back and cried, while saying, “Woe to you, O life! Your abundance is truly

little, your little is short lived, we were deceived by you.” Allah warns those who do not join Jihad, p&syXu Iji—W ilf you march not forth, He will punish you with a painful torment Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah’s Messenger jg called some Arabs to mobilize, but they lagged behind and Allah withheld rain from coming down on them, and this was their torment.” * Allah said, iand will replace you by another people}, who will give aid to His Prophet 0, and establish his religion. Allah said in another Ayah, Q&-3 2 iAnd if you turn away (from the obedience to Allah), He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} [47 :38] > -i >< iand you cannot harm Him at all}, you can never harm Allah when you lag behind and stay away from joining Jihad, iand Allah is able to do all things.} He is able to destroy the enemies without your help. o. h £3^ it St *2^ Hi jjJi at Y ii jdS at ^)2Lilt l\ffk£=s t 1 ' At-Tabari 14:255.

430 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 440. Ifyou help him (Muhammad j&) not (it does not matter), for Allah did indeed help him when the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two; when they were both in the cave, he said to his companion : "Be not sad (or afraid), surely, Allah is with us." Then Allah sent down His Sakinah (calmness, tranquillity, peace) upon him, and strengthened him with forces (angels) which you saw not, and made the word of those who disbelieved the lowermost, while the Word ofAllah that became the uppermost; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.} Allah supports.His Prophet^ Allah said, 4ffyou help him not}, ifyou do not support His Prophet jg, then it does not matter, for Allah will help, support, suffice and protect him, just as He did, 4J3 Sjf s&i iwhen the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two;} During the year of the Hijrah, the idolators tried to kill, imprison or expel the Prophet jg, who escaped with his friend and Companion, Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhafah, to the cave of Thawr. They remained in the cave for three days so that the pagans who were sent in their pursuit, returned (to Makkah), and they proceed to Al-Madlnah. While in the cave, Abu Bakr was afraid the pagans might discover them for fear that some harm might touch the Messenger The Prophet jg kept reassuring him and strengthening his resolve, saying, iiiii jisu Jilt u d l;} «0 Abu Bakr! What do you think about two, with Allah as their third? [1] Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas that Abu Bakr said to him, “I said to the Prophet when we were in the cave, If any of m Fath Al-Bdri 8:176.

431Surah 9. At-Tawbah (40) (Part-10) them looks down at his feet, he will see us.’ He said, < Jit fciivb Li i Cl U» iO Abu Bakr! What do you think about two with Allah as their third?*' This is recorded in the Two SahthsP This is why Allah said, iThen Allah sent down His Sakinah upon him> sent His aid and triumph to His Messenger jg, or they say it refers to Abu Bakr, iand strengthened him with forces which you saw not}, the angels, 4\\$K ji 1^=6 fcjSs- iand made the word of those who disbelieved the lowermost while the Word ofAllah that became the uppermost;} Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “The word of those who disbelieved’, is Shirk, while, The Word of Allah’ is ‘La. ilaha illalldh.”*31 It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu MQsa Al-Ash‘ari said, “The Messenger of Allah jg was asked about a man who fights because of courage, or out of rage for his honor, or to show off. Whom among them is in the cause of Allah?’ The Prophet said, •<*' ^& diii& jit bM jits *He who fights so that Allah's Word is superior, then he fights in Allah's cause.**4 Allah said next, 4& iand Allah is All-Mighty}, in His revenge and taking retribution, He is the Most Formidable and those who seek refuge with Him and take shelter by adhering to what He instructs sure never *** Ahmad 1 :4. * FatfiAl-Bari 7:11 and Muslim 4 :1854 At-Tabari 14:261. I4 * Fath Al-Bari 1 :286 and Muslim 3 :1512.

U flap jA \j L_4jjlilij. Aj^N'j^Ur^j\^S^5^ 6L££Llt u'-^'-itatLlS'V |tr <***Z*^< *s Jj'yjUo yKcddj'j^2"> 4Iu.^iy.^ ^ dp dSy. made to suffer injustice, 4All-Wise}, in His statements and ac- tions. [>J-£»-j MLjJj lilli. \$ 'Jrh— 4 (&\$J oi p z p& 4ik^^ 441 . March forth, whether you are light or heavy, and strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause of Allah. This is better for you, ifyou but knew.} Jihad is required in all Conditions Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from his father from Abu Ad-Duha, Muslim bin Subayh, who said This Ayah, lillj \£-J} 4March forth, whether you are light or heavy} was the first part to be revealed from Surah Bara'ah."|11 Mu'tamir bin Sulayman narrated that his father said, "Hadrami claimed that he was told that some people used to declare that they will not gain sin (if they lag behind the forces of Jihad} because they are ill or old. This Ayah was revealed, 4^j ft m At-Tabari 14:270.

433Surah 9. At-Tawbah (41) (Part-10) iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy . Allah commanded mass mobilization together with the Messenger of Allah sg for the battle of Tabuk, to fight the disbelieving, People of the Book, the Romans, Allah's enemies. Allah ordained that the believers all march forth with the Messenger jg regardless whether they felt active, lazy, at ease or had difficult circumstances, iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy^ 'Ali bin Zayd narrated that Anas said that Abu Talhah commented (on this Ayah), "Whether you are old or young, Allah did not leave an excuse for anyone." Abu Talhah marched to Ash-Sham and fought until he was killed. In another narration, Abu Talhah recited Surah Bara'ah until he reached this Ayah, 4 '<f=Ay\ ^ iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy, and strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause ofAllah .} He then said, "I see that Allah had called us to mobilize whether we are old or young. O my children! Prepare my supplies." His children said, *May Allah grant you His mercy! You conducted Jihad along with the Messenger of Allah jg until he died, then with Abu Bakr until he died, then with TJmar until he died. Let us perform Jihad in your place." Abu Talhah refused and he went to the sea [under the command of Mu'awiyah] where he died. They could not find an island to buiy him on until nine days later, during which his body did not deteriorate or change and they buried him on the island.12 As-Suddi said, lili* 1 iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy}, whether you are rich, poor, strong, or weak. A man came forward, and he was fat, complained, and asked for permission to stay behind [from 111 At-Tabari 14:266 > IbnAbi HStim 6:1802.

JViad\, but the Prophet jgg refused. Then this Ayah, iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy} was revealed, and it became hard on the people. So Allah abrogated it with this Ayah, .-r, t" 4 &- 4 !> ", 4There is no blame on those who are weak or ill or whofind no resources to spend, if they are sincere and true (in duty) to Allah and His Messenger} (9:91)." Ibn Jarir said that Hibban bin Zayd Ash-Shar'abi narrated to him, "We mobilized our forces with Safw&n bin 'Amr, who was the governor of Hims towards the city of Ephsos appointed to the Jerajima Christian expatriates (in Syria). I saw among the army an old, yet active man, whose eyebrows had sunk over his eyes (from old age), from the residents of Damascus, riding on his animal. I said to him, 'O uncle! Allah has given you an excuse (to lag behind).' He said, 'O my nephew! Allah has mobilized us whether we are light or heavy. Verily, those whom Allah loves, He tests them. Then to Allah is their return and eternal dwelling. Allah tests from His servants whoever thanks (Him) and observes patience and remembrance of Him, all the while worshipping Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, and worshipping none else.'" Next, Allah encourages spending in His cause and striving with one's life in His pleasure and the pleasure of His

Messenger jg. 4 4p% Ja 4p&jp&\ } iand strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause of Allah. This is better for you, if you but knew.} Allah says, this is better for you in this life and the Hereafter. You might spend small amounts, but Allah will reward you the property of your enemy in this life, as well as, the honor that He will keep for you in the Hereafter. The m At-Jabari 14:264.

Prophet said, JU Uj aJjia J! ' u>-J! a1>-x ol oU^j OJ ^ <il **«=* J Oi promised the Mujahid in His cause that if He brings death to him, He will enter him into Paradise. Or, He will return him to his house with whatever reward and war spoils he earns .»ll) So Allah said; yti J Js-*j j~" S*J iJihdd is ordained for you (Muslims) though you dislike it, and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you and that you like a thing which is bad for you . Allah knows but you do not know.^[2:216] Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah ;§g said to a man, jEmbrace Islam , » but the man said, "I dislike doing so." The Messenger jg said, ciS' ip oEmbrace Islam even if you dislike)& illll^ i,£ '£}j&& ii*li Q^ if 4Cpiju£j\$ jOi% 3££ Ggfc 442 . Had it been a near gain and an easy journey, they would have followed you, but the distance was long far them; and they would swear by Allah: "If we only could, we would certainly have come forth with you." They destroy themselves, and Allah knows that they are liars. I1 ' Muslim 4 :1496. 121 Ahmad 3:109.

436 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Why Hypocrites would not join in Jihad Allah admonishes those who lagged behind and did not join the Prophet jg for the battle of TabCik, those who asked the Prophet for permission to remain behind, falsely pretending to have legitimate reasons to do so, 4Had it been a near gain}, booty right in front of them, according to Ibn 'Abbas, iand an easy journey}, travel for only a short distance, <&\$} ithey would have followed you.} But, 4&\^ £,£ '&',} ithe distance was long for them}, to Ash-Sham, iand they would swear by Allah}, when you return to them, ipZ. S-yL O&Jl)} if we only could, we would certainly have come forth with you}, had not there been a valid excuse, we would have gone out with you, idjJZi j&j iThey destroy themselves, and Allah knows that they are liars.} V jXdj lyl— JL+5 p, Jit \12} ol »•?' ' 'li 443. Mai/ Allah forgive you. Why did you grant them leave, until those who told the truth were manifest to you, and you had known the liars?}

444. Those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, would not ask your leave to be exempted from fighting with their properties and their lives; and Allah is the All-Knower of those who have Taqwd.}

445. It is only those who believe not in Allah and the Last Day and whose hearts are in doubt that ask your leave. So in their doubts they waver. Moderately criticizing the Prophet^ for allowing the Hypocrites to stay behind Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Awn said, "Have you heard criticism softer than this, starting with forgiveness before criticism, 4P £s\$ p,dxU&&} 4May Allah forgive you . Why did you grant them leave . >?"m Muwarriq Al-ljli and others said similarly.*2 * Qatadah said, "Allah criticized him as you read here, then later revealed to him the permission to allow them to lag behind if he wants, in Surat An-Niir, ip*^4 p; pbpj f# 4So if they ask your permission for some affairs of theirs, give permission to whom you will of them} [24:62]. ""3 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said similarly. Mujahid said, "This Ayah was revealed about some people who said, 'Ask permission from the Messenger of Allah [to stay behind], and whether he agrees, or disagrees, remain behind!'"4 * Allah said, 4t4-> pj' 4 ...until those who told the truth were manifest to you}, in reference to valid excuses, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 6:1805. 121 At-Tabari 14:274. 131 At-Tabari 14:273. 141 At-Tabari 14:273.

446. And if they had intended to march out, certainly, they would have made some preparation for it; but Allah was averse to their being sent forth, so He made them lag behind, and it was said (to them): "Sit among those who sit (at home)."} 447. Had they marched out with you, they would have added to you nothing except disorder, and they would have hurried about in your midst (spreading corruption) and sowing sedition among you - and there are some among you who would have listened to them. And Allah is the All-Knower of the wrongdoers.} Exposing Hypocrites Allah said, iAnd if they had intended to march out,}, with you to participate in Jihad iiZ % \&i} 4icertainly, they would have made some preparationfor it} they would have prepared for such task, 5ii &j} ibut Allah was averse to their being sentforth} All&h hated that they should go with you. 4so He made them lag behind, and stay away (from Jihad\, iand it was said (to them): "Sit you among those who sit (at home)" } as a part of what was decreed for them [not that He legislated that they stay behind]. Allah then explained why He disliked

that they march with the believers, saying, \$Had they marched out with you, they would have added to you nothing except disorder}, because they are cowards and failures, iand they would have hurried about in your midst' sowing sedition among you} They would have rushed to spread false stories, hatred and discord among you, , <c£ && iand there are some among you who would have listened to them.} who would have obeyed them, given preference to their speech and words and asked them for advice, unaware of the true reality of these hypocrites. This might have caused corruption and great evil between the believers. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "Those who sought permission (from the Messenger to lag behind) included some of the chiefs, such as 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul and Al-Jadd bin Qays, who were masters of their people. Allah also made them lag behind because He knew that if they went along with the Messenger sg they would sow sedition in his army." I 1 ' There were some in the Prophet's army who liked these chiefs and were ready to obey them, because they considered them honorable, iand there are some among you wlv would have listened to them} (9:47]. Allah next reminds of His perfect knowledge, saying, 111 At-Tabari 14:277. This narration is not authentic, it has been left here because it was the only one mentioned for the explanation

%\$?\ ? v m 0) f- %z *tv\$} fy hi£? ra# 4ff 15^^ £ il=fi if JT^f! * " {£ ? £# If. ft fetj 'puB 'legrg] 4(i{ftu} atp of) uotsjaan tptm dvcnv patunf anvq fnq p\noai datp 'Ud)Sfi utatp apvtu pvi[api ft itana puv ! uaijstj uiaig apoui navi/ paaput pinom afq 'utatp ut pooS fiuvfo uoiotoi qvpy pvjqt &Cf 4^ iffy 4/1 f <7f .. «»»« rff\ <r 'l8S :9l i suvfi aw datp paaput puy uappiqjcf auaoi /hip qaiifni fvip oj fjaoau dpitviJaa pinotn /hip '(pjuom atp of) patutpau auacn /hip ft)tig\$> <% D*/< 0 if\ TTT ' ;vfiy jbjuijis ux pres qBjjv •jou ptp Xatp qSnoqj U3A3 'pgqojBux Xaq; peq auop 3ABq pjnoM Xaqj jeqM Supeoipui 4'uapjostp fdaaxa 8ui -tpou nod o) pappv anvtf ppiom datp 'nod tpini Ino patpjvm datp pup} if r??\ 'tf ? 9f\$ ^ 'sb qons 'jnaao p\no/a }i Moq 'pajjnaoo 3ABq pinoM SuxqpfriB jx puB jnaoo [[ia\ }Bq/A 'pajjnoDO }Bq/v\ SAVOuq 3H ?eqj sXbs qBqv 4-suaopSuojoj atp fo J3nioujj -UV *P si my puy> ^n fe~"-T vC raj rr\ nr~Cr^~^ Z*S'> ' «' 'SJf' J. « Of 'Z'X < 'Si>S s-y ' rrvr-Tr-^^Cr^-iV rr }es ^V ^\$ ^ Cnea? ^ (Ol-Wd) (8f - ZW TjvqnwLW '6PiIW

443Surah 9. At-Tawbah (48 - 49) (Part-10) put me not into trial." Surely, they have fallen into trial. And verily, Hell is surrounding the disbelievers.} Allah says, some hypocrites say to you, O Muhammad \$jg, 44&*} 4Grant me leave}, to stay behind, iand put me not into trial.}, if I go with you and see the

women of the Romans. Allah, the Exalted, replied, jJt 4\$} iSurely, they have fallen into trial} because of the statement they uttered. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Az-Zuhri, Yazid bin Ruwman, 'Abdullah bin Abi Bakr, 'Asim bin Qatadah and several others that they said, "The Messenger of Allah said to Al-Jadd bin Qays from Bani Salimah, - , . 4 , - . ^ J fUJl i?- C dll «WomW you like to fight the yellow ones (Romans) this year? He said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Give me permission (to remain behind) and do not cause Fitnah for me. By Allah! My people know that there is not a man who is more fond of women than I. I fear that if I see the women of the yellow ones, I would not be patient.' The Messenger of Allah jg turned away from him and said, , , , f oJil «/ give you permission .» In Al-Jadd's case, this Ayah was revealed, 4And among them is he who says: "Grant me leave and put me not into trial."} Therefore, Allah says that the Fitnah that he fell into because of not joining the Messenger of Allah 4g (in Jihad) and preferring his safety to the safety of the Messenger is worse than the Fitnah that he falsely claimed to fear."111 It was 111 At-Tabari 14:287.

444 os0 tS53^ IZrgi&-J o0 4but if a calamity overtakes you, they say: "YJe took our precaution beforehand,"), they say, we took precautions when we did not join him, 4and they turn away rejoicing.)' Allah directed His Prophet jg to reply to the perfect enmity they have towards him, 4\$) 4Say), to them, 4Nothing shall ever happen to us except what Allah has ordained far us.) for we are under His control and decree, 4&3y y) 4He is our Mawld.), Master and protector, 4And in Allah let the believers put their trust) [9:51], and we trust in Him. Verily, He is sufficient for us and what an excellent guardian. iit J j\$C 'Vi\ ji 3) li'fa \$ &\$» j* (^~**« ^i Vi sfa oi ^4^* ^y J Vi Sjiii Vj Jyfc VJ / . 452. Say: "Do yow ioaif ybr ms (anything) except one of the two best things; while we await far you either that Allah will afflict you with a punishment from Himself or at our hands. So wait, we too are waiting with you") 453. Say: "Spend willingly or unwillingly, it will not be

447 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (54 - 55) (Part-10) who are rebellious.} Allah mentions the

reason behind not accepting their charity from them, A % 4except that they disbelieved in Allah and in His Messenger.} and the deeds are accepted if they are preceded with faith, # ^ 2# %} iand that they came not to the Saldh except in a lazy state.} Therefore, they neither have good intention nor eagerness to perform the acts [of faith], J V. cJJuiJt ^ Az>A ^ A\iOjijp tj^ A !E*- Vi^ ol Cj} 2jAj4 Vj j'^=> V] ijLii)' iAnd nothing prevents their contributions from being accepted from them except that they disbelieved in Allah and in His Messenger, and that they came not to the Saldh (the prayer except in a lazy state, and that they offer not contributions but unwillingly.} The Truthful, to whom the Truth was revealed, Muhammad, peace be upon him, said that Allah does not stop giving rewards until you (believers) stop performing good deeds, and that Allah is Tayyib [Good and Pure] and only accepts what is Tayyib. This is why Allah does not accept charity or good

448 Tafsir Ibt Kathir deeds from the people described in these Ayat, because He only accepts it from those who have Taqwa. erf ysn 4 ^ 'it q^ % q&t^ %} 455. So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.} Allah says to His Messenger sg, iSo let not their wealth nor their children amaze you...} In similar Ayat, Allah said, - c sr- •A'j dLy x- xV ipj •x*j | *(ix Wi>jt IXJ lii. u i<&le 4And strain not your eyes in longing far the things We have given far enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them

thereby. But the provision (good reward in the Hereafter) of your Lord is better and more lasting} [20:131], and, tAi y S 4 fi fed f»s4jy JU' jx .4f /li iDo they think that in wealth and children with which We enlarge them. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} [23:55-56]. Allah said next, iQ% \ -gw 4 ^ it i,;q> iin reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world,} by taking the Zakah due on their money from them and spending it in Allah's cause, according to the meaning given by Al-Hasan Al-Basri. HI At-Tabari 14:296.

449Surah 9. At-Tawbah (55 - 57) (Part-10) Allah's statement, 4and that their souls shall depart while they are disbelievers means, so that when Allah brings death to them, they will still be disbelievers, to make matters worse for them and the torment more severe. We seek refuge from such an end, which includes being led astray gradually by these things which they have. ijij } o> <56. They swear by Allah that they are truly ofyou while they are not ofyou, but they are a people (hypocrites) who are afraid (that you may kill them).} i57. Should they find a refuge, or caves, or a place of concealment, they ivould turn straightway thereto with a sivift rush.} Exposing Hypocrites' Fright and Fear Allah describes to His Prophet jg the fright, fear, anxiety and nervousness of the hypocrites, 4They swear by Allah that they are truly ofyou}, swearing a sure oath, iwhile they are not ofyou}, in reality, ibut they are a people who are afraid}, and this is what made them swear.)} 4Should they find a refuge}, such as a fort in which they hide and fortify themselves,

451Surah 9. At-Tawbah (58 - 59) (Part-10) 4And ofthem}, among the hypocrites, {who accuse you} or question your integrity, {concerning}, division of, {c&lSti} {the alms}, when you divide them. They question your fairness, even though it is they who deserve that their integrity be questioned. The hypocrites do not do this in defense of the religion, but to gain more for themselves. This is why, {If they are given} meaning, from the Zakdh, Jf) \£> } {They are pleased, but if they are not given thereof, behold! They are enraged!} (9:58), angry for themselves. Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, {And ofthem are some who accuse you concerning the alms.} "Allah says, 'Some of them question your integrity in the matter of distribution of the alms.' We were told that a bedouin man, who had recently embraced Islam, came to the Prophet 5^5, when he was dividing some gold and silver, and said to him, 'O Muhammad! Even though Allah commanded you to divide in fairness, you have not done so.' The Prophet of Allah 3^ said, id* jji ^jji ii ifs "Woe to you! Who would befair to you after me then? n The Prophet of Allah^ said next, ^ ^ oCil 'jt |JLi

«Beware of this man and his likes! There are similar persons in my Ummah who recite the Qur'an, but the Qur'an will not go beyond their throat. If they rise (against Muslims rulers) then kill them, if they rise, kill them, then if they rise kill them. We were also told that the Prophet of Allah jg used to say, «jjli Of 1*jJ 'ij U-i U •jJj By He in Whose Hand is my life! I do not give or withhold anything; I am only a keeper.s"111 This statement from Qatadah is similar to the HacLith that the Two Shaykhs narrated from Abu Said about the story of Dhul-Khuwaysirah, whose name was Hurqus. Hurqus protested against the Prophet's division of the war spoils of Hunayn, saying, "Be fair, for you have not been fair!" The Prophet jg said, •JjLP-l jsi jU u! -^ a »/ would have become a loser and a failure if I was not fair! The Messenger jg said after that man left, jt jjy 04-^* ly e.UiJl «Among the offspring of this man will be some with whose prayer, when one ofyou sees it, would belittle his prayer, and his fast as compared to their fast. They will be renegades from the religion, just like an arrow goes through the game's body.

Wherever you find them, kill them, for verily, they are the worst dead people under the cover of the sky .**21 Allah said next, while directing such people to what is more beneficial for them than their behavior, ji& 4f 1ipj feu 41 C vj% & 4Would that they were content with what Allah and His 111 At-Tabari 14:302. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 12 :302 and Muslim 2 :744

Messenger gave them and had said: "Allah is sufficient for us. Allah will give us of His bounty, and so will His Messenger (from alms). We implore Allah (to enrich us)."} This honorable Ayah contains a gracious type of conduct and an honorable secret. Allah listed; contentment with what He and His Messenger jg give, trusting in Allah alone - by saying; iand they had said: Allah is sufficient for us}, and hoping in Allah alone, and He made these the indications of obedience to the Messenger sfe, adhering to his commands, avoiding his prohibitions, believing his narrations and following his footsteps. vty 'Mo M Q fi'. Jib\$ Jc*-' s b O' 460. As-Sadaqat (i.e., Zakah) are only for the Fttqara and Al- Masdkin and those employed to collect (the funds); and to attract the hearts of those who have been inclined (towards Islam); and to free the captives; and for those in debt; and for Allah's cause, and for Ibn As-Sabit; a duty imposed by Alldlt. And Allah is AU-Knower, All-Wise.} Expenditures of Zakah (Alms) After Allah mentioned the protest that the ignorant hypocrites mentioned to the Prophet jg about the distribution of alms. He stated that it is He who divided the alms, explained its rulings and decided in its division; He did not delegate this decision to anyone else. Allah mentioned the expenditures of Zakah in this Ayah, starting with the Fuqara' (the poor) because they have more need than the other categories, since their need is pressing and precarious. It was reported that Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ibn Zayd and several others said that the Fatpr is a graceful person who does not ask anyone for anything, while the Miskin is the one who follows after people, begging. Qatadah said, "The Fatpr is the ill person, while the Miskin. is physically fit." ' We will now mention the 111 At-Tabari 14:305-306. At-Tabari 14:306.

Hadiths about each of these eight categories The Fuqara (Poor) Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sgj said, ^ 1 V «77ie alms should not be given to the wealthy and the physically fit .» Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith.^ The Masakin (Needy) Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, iliUi ^jJi oi>3i ^4J» *\\?«j V !Jli b I : IjJU (jC uLi jL; ij t}ii ii ^ zThe needy person is not the one who goes round the people and asks them for a mouthful or two (of meals) or a date or two». They asked, "Then who is the needy person, O Allah's Messenger!" He said, "The one who does not have enough to satisfy his needs and whose condition is not known to others, that others may give him something in charity, and who does not beg of people.» The Two Shaykhs collected this Hadith Those employed to collect Alms Those employed to collect alms deserve a part of the alms, unless they are relatives of the Messenger of Allah 5^5 , who are not allowed to accept any Sadaqah. Muslim recorded that 'Abdul-Muttalib bin Rabl'ah bin Al-Harith and Al-Fadl bin Al- 'Abbas went to the Messenger of Allah jg asking him to employ them to collect the alms. The Messenger replied, Infill ^ £1 4jIAl JV Vj xJJii J>J V Ujxi}I oi» vVerily, the alms are not allowed for Muhammad nor the relatives of Muhammad, for it is only the dirt that the people I 1 * Ahmad 4 :164 , Abu Dawud 2 :285 and TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 3 :317 121 Fath Al-Bari 3 :399 and Muslim 2:719.

455Surah 9. At-Tawbah (60) (Part-10) discard Al-Mu'allafatu Quffibuhum There are several types of Al-Mu'allafatu Qulubuhum. There are those who are given alms to embrace Islam. For instance, the

Prophet of Allah gave something to Safwan bin Umayyah from the war spoils of Hunayn, even though he attended it while a Mushrik. Safwan said, “He kept giving me until he became the dearest person to me after he had been the most hated person to me.”²¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that Safwan bin Umayyah said, “The Messenger of Allah jg gave me (from the spoils of) Hunayn while he was the most hateful person to me. He kept giving me until he became the most beloved person to me.”³¹ Muslim and At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith, as well.⁴¹ Some of Al-Mu’aUafatu Qulubuhum are given from alms so that they become better in Islam and their heart firmer in faith. For instance, the Prophet jg gave some of the chiefs of the Tulaqa’ a hundred camels each after the battle of Hunayn, saying, £ ^ 41^ M tU- O t}\ Y£’3 Ji. «/ give a man (from the alms) while another man is dearer to me than him, forfear that Allah might throw him on his face in the fire ofJahannam .»⁵¹ It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Said said that ‘Ali sent the Messenger of Allah jg a gold nugget still in its dirt from Yemen. The Prophet jg divided it between four men: Al- Aqra’ bin Habis, TJyaynah bin Badr, ‘Alqamah bin TJlathah and Zayd Al-Khayr, saying, “To draw their hearts closer.»⁶¹ Some people are given because Muslim 2:752. Muslim 4:1806. 131 Ahmad 6:465. ⁴¹ Muslim 4 :1806 and TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi3 :334 | S1 Fath Al-Bari 3 :399 161 Fath Al-Bari 6 :433 and Muslim 2 :741

some of his peers might embrace Islam, while others are given to collect alms from surrounding areas, or to defend Muslim outposts. Allah knows best. TheRiqab Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Muqatil bin Hayyan, ‘Umar bin ‘Abdul- ‘Aziz, Said bin Jubayr, An-Nakhal, Az-Zuhri and Ibn Zayd said Riqab means those slaves who make an agreement with the master to pay a certain ransom for their freedom.”¹¹¹ Similar was reported from Abu Musa Al-Ash’ari . Ibn ‘Abbas and Al-Hasan said, “It is allowed to use Zakah funds to buy the freedom of slaves,” indicating that ‘Riqab’ has more general meanings than merely giving money to slaves to buy their freedom or one’s buying a slave and freeing him on an individual basis. A Hadith states that for every limb [of the servant) freed, Allah frees a limb of the one who freed him from slavery, even a sexual organ for a sexual organ, for the reward is equitable to the deed, 'ply iAtid you will be requited nothing except Jbr what you used to do.) [37:39] Virtue offreeing Slaves In the Musnad, there is a Hadith from Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib that a man asked, “O Allah’s Messenger! Direct me to an action that draws me closer to Paradise and away from the Fire.” The Messenger of Allah jj§ said, • siiij in .i.i.U «Emancipate the person andfree the neck (slave). The man asked, “O Allah’s Messenger! Are they not one and the same?” He said, • - Ojit J l i l) 1 t : •No, you emancipate a person byfreeing him on your own, but ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 14:317. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 14:316.

457Surah 9. At-Tawbah (60) (Part-10) you untie a neck (slave) by helping in its priced Al-GH&rimun (the Indebted) There are severed types of indebted persons. They include those who incur expenses in solving disputes between people, those who guarantee a loan that became due, causing financial strain to them, and those whose funds do not sufficiently cover their debts. It also includes those who indulged in a sin and repented from it. These types have a right to a part of alms (designated for Al-Gharimun). Qablsah bin Mukhariq Al-Hilali said, “I carried a debt [resolving a dispute between people] and went to the Messenger of Allah asking him to help pay it. The Messenger said, G Jjj \alli *iXuai\ li-Jii y.>- «Be patient until some alms are brought to us so that we give it to yoM.» He then said, c.,l~>o L*- ^ j] m-j U <J d>j dU *ILLJl If* \s\X* :J\ S j\ - jLs, j* Ul^* JjtljJl jl£] : j jXj ***y £ly Jili - iJtlp^ iSIjl. : JI* j(- Jls- If* lilji t/5* *• J ciLi Sill *L»L* 1- .> .» SjLlJl j* Vyf Li aO Qabisah! Begging is only allowed for three: a man who incurred debts solving disputes, so he is allowed to beg until he

collects its amount and then stops. A man who was inflicted by a disaster that consumed his wealth, he is allowed to beg until he collects what suffices for his livelihood. And a man who was overcome by poverty, that three wise relatives of his stand up and proclaim, 'So-and-so was overcome by poverty.' This man is allowed to beg until he collects what sustains his livelihood. Other than these cases, begging is an unlawful amount that one **' Ahmad 4 :299

458 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir illegally devours .» Muslim collected this Hadith.[^] Abu Saïd said, "During the time of the Messenger of Allah Si, a man was struck by disaster because of fruits that he bought, causing him extensive debts. The Prophet said, *Give him charity .» The people did that but the amount collected did not cover his debts. The Prophet Si said to the man's debtors, *Take what was collected, you will have nothing beyond that Muslim collected this Hadith In the Cause of Allah In the cause of Allah is exclusive for the benefit of the fighters in Jihad, who do not receive compensation from the Muslim Treasury. Ibn As-Sabil (Wayfarer) Ibn As-Sabn is a term used for the needy traveler in a land, where he does not have what helps him continue his trip. This type has a share in the Zakah for what suffices him to reach his destination, even if he had money there. The same is true for whoever intends to travel from his area but does not have enough money. This type also has a share in the Zakah money to suffice for his trip and back. This is proven in the Ayah as well as the following Hadith. Imams Abu D&wud and Ibn Majah recorded that Ma'mar said that Zayd bin Aslam said that 'Ata' bin Yasar said that Abu Saïd Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg\$ said, jt iaJUj ji-j j\ ilfcU i : 1-iJ Yj yJLSJl *Sadaqah is not rightful for a wealthy person except in five Muslim 2:722. 121 Muslim 3:1161.

cases: those employed to collect it, one who bought a charity item with his money, a Ghdrim (debtor), a fighter in the cause of Allah, or a poor man who gets a part of the Zakah so he gives it as a gift to a rich man. o' 11 Allah's statement, 4a duty imposed by Allah means, a decision, decree and division ordained by Allah, 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise knowledgeable of all things outwardly and inwardly and what benefits His servants, 4U[^] 4All-Wise}, in all what he declares, does, legislates and decides, there is no true deity or lord except Him. A p-\$ ji 5a \$ && p\$ «3j iA*» 461 . And among them are men who annoy the Prophet and say: "He is (lending his) ear (to every news)." Say: "He listens to what is best for you; he believes in Allah; has faith in the believers; and is a mercy to those of you who believe." But those who annoy Allah's Messenger, will have a painful torment.} Hypocrites annoy the Prophet& Allah says, some hypocrites bother the Messenger of Allah jg by questioning his character, saying, 4he is (lending his) ear}, to those who say anything about us; he believes whoever talks to him. Therefore, if we went to him and swore, he would believe us. Similar was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qat&dahJ2 ' Allah said, Abu D&wud 2 :288 and Ibn MAjah 1 :590. ' Al-Tabari 14:326. This narration is Mursal.

iSay: "He listens to what is best for you"}, he knows who's saying the truth and who is lying, ihe believes in Allah; has faith in the believers}, he believes the believers, -4'4 3-jj} iand is a mercy to those of you who believe"}, and a proof against the disbelievers, ft 3 4A> \$Ajd 4But those who annoy Allah's Messenger, will have a painful torment.} g \j£. % }>\3a f. (3 ^ 462. They swear by Allah to you (Muslims) in order to please you, but it is more fitting that they should please Allah and His Messenger, if they are believers.} 463. Know they not that whoever opposes and shows hostility to Allah and His

Messenger, certainly for him will be the fire of Hell to abide therein. That is the extreme disgrace.} Hypocrites revert to Lies to please People Qatadah said about Allah's statement,

iThey swear by Allah to you (Muslims) in order to please you "A hypocrite man said, By Allah! They (hypocrites) are our chiefs and masters. If what Muhammad says is true, they are worse than donkeys.' A Muslim man heard him and declared, "By Allah! What Muhammad says is true and you are worse than a donkey!' The Muslim man conveyed what happened to the Prophet who summoned the hypocrite and asked him, 'What made you say what you said'? That man invoked curses on himself and swore by Allah that he never said that. Meanwhile, the Muslim man said, 'O Allah! Assert the truth of the truthful and expose the lies of the liar.' Allah revealed this Verse." Allah's statement, "Whoever opposes and shows hostility to Allah and His Messenger, we will certainly punish him; he will be the fire of Hell to abide therein", in a humiliating torment, "That is the extreme disgrace" (9:63), that is the greatest disgrace and the tremendous misery. 464. The hypocrites fear lest a Surah should be revealed about them, showing them what is in their hearts. Say: "(Go ahead and) mock! But certainly Allah will bring to light all that you fear." At-Tabari 14:329.

The Hypocrites fear Public Exposure of Their Secrets Mujahid said, "The hypocrites would say something to each other then declare, We wish that Allah does not expose this secret of ours," 111 There is a similar Ayah to this one, that is, Allah's statement, "And when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not, and say within themselves: "Why should Allah punish us not for what we say?" Hell will be sufficient for them; they will burn therein. And worst indeed is that destination!" [58:8] Allah said in this Ayah, "Say: "(Go ahead and) mock! But certainly Allah will bring to light all that you fear He will expose and explain your reality to His Messenger through revelation. Allah said in other Ayat, "Or do those in whose hearts is a disease (of hypocrisy), think that Allah will not bring to light all their hidden ill-wills?" (47:29), until, "But surely, you will know them by the tone of their speech!" [47:30]. This is why, according to Qatadah, this Surah is called 'Al-Fadiah' (the Exposing), because it exposed the hypocrites. 121 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "During the battle of Tabuk, a man was sitting in a gathering and said, 'I have never seen like these reciters of ours! They have the hungriest stomachs, the most lying tongues and are the most cowardice in battle.' A man in the Masjid said, 'You lie. You are a hypocrite, and I will surely inform the Messenger of Allah, This statement was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah and also a part of the Qur'an was revealed about it.'" 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "I have seen that man afterwards holding onto the shoulders of the Messenger's camel while stones were falling on him, declaring, 'O Allah's Messenger! We were only engaged in idle talk and jesting,' while the Messenger of Allah was reciting, "Was it at Allah, and His Aydt and His

463 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (65 - 66) (Part-10) 465. If you ask them (about this), they declare: "We were only talking idly and joking." Say: "Was it at Allah, and His Aydt and His Messenger that you were mocking?" 466. Make no excuse; you disbelieved after you had believed. If We pardon some of you, We will punish others among you because they were criminals.} The Hypocrites rely on False, Misguided Excuses 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "During the battle of Tabuk, a man was sitting in a gathering and said, 'I have never seen like these reciters of ours! They have the hungriest stomachs, the most lying tongues and are the most cowardice in battle.' A man in the Masjid said, 'You lie. You are a hypocrite, and I will surely inform the Messenger of Allah, This statement was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah and also a part of the Qur'an was revealed about it.'" 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "I have seen that man afterwards holding onto the shoulders of the Messenger's camel while stones were falling on him, declaring, 'O Allah's Messenger! We were only engaged in idle talk and jesting,' while the Messenger of Allah was reciting, "Was it at Allah, and His Aydt and His

Messenger that you were mocking?"} [9:65]. "x| Allah said, 4Make no excuse; you disbelieved after you had believed.} on account of your statement and mocking, mli j&s & JZ 0\} 4If We pardon some of you, We will punish others among you} for not all of you will be forgiven, some will have to taste the torment, 4because they were criminals}, they were criminals because of this (i) At-Tabari 14:333.

terrible, sinful statement. 467. The hypocrites, men and women, are one from another; they enjoin evil, and forbid the good, and they close their hands. They have forgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them. Verily, the hypocrites are the rebellious.} 468. Allah has promised the hypocrites - men and women - and the disbelievers, the fire of Hell; therein shall they abide. It will suffice them. Allah has cursed them and for them is the lasting torment. Other Characteristics of Hypocrites Allah admonishes the hypocrites who, unlike the believers, who enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, 4(4:^\ ofiafoj j 4they enjoin evil, and forbid the good, and they close their hands4, from spending in Allah's cause, \y^\} 4They have forgotten Allah}, they have forgotten the remembrance of Allah, 4so He has forgotten them.}, by treating them as if He has forgotten them. Allah also, Xty.M 'J-j Jjj} 4And it will be said: "This Day We will forget you as you forgot the meeting of this Day of yours} [45:34] Allah said, 4by~j.1' jUiUl' -^fo} 4 Verily, the hypocrites are the rebellious}

the rebellious from the way of truth who embrace the wicked way, 4Allah has promised the hypocrites - men and women - and the disbelievers, the fire of Hell}, on account of their evil doing mentioned here, iQ. 4therein shall they abide.}, for eternity, they and the disbelievers, 4It will suffice them.}, as a torment, iAllah has cursed them}, He expelled and banished them [from His mercy], i^ 4and for them is the lasting torment.} l&LX %fa S3 'fas * &\$?} faj J-fa* fal dfa jpx fak falL\ pi ci (H^>>^\ iXf- 469. Like those before you: they were mightier than you in power, and more abundant in wealth and children. They had enjoyed their portion (a while), so enjoy your portion (a while) as those before you enjoyed their portion (a while); and you

IpIjj < jJu jh-1j \j~ 1 4 <il Jj—j (•» r* S-^ii cjt-4' 1 «oj>~1~>-jj ^ : Jli ?vlkjl 'Uy He in Whose Hand is my sow// You will follow the traditions of those who were before you a hand span for a hand- span and forearm's length for forearm's length, and an arm's length for an arm's length. And even if they enter the den of a lizard, you will also enter it." They asked, "Who, O Allah's Messenger, the People of the Book?" He said, «IA7io else?"^ This Hadith is similar to another Hadith collected in the Sahth. Jjiiij fSj gy fy^U oi t}f Ooj {+\$1 fit a j\$f <70. Has not the story reached them of those before them? - The people of Nuh/Ad, Thamiid, the people of Ibrahim, the dwellers of Madyan and the overturned cities; to them came their Messengers with clear proofs. So it was not Allah Who wronged them, but they used to wrong themselves. Advising the Hypocrites to learn a Lesson from Those before Them Allah advises the hypocrites who reject the Messengers, 4.Z-& &, iity iHas not the story reached them of those before them?} have you (hypocrites) not learned the end of the nations before you who rejected the Messengers, 4The people of Nuh}, and the flood that drowned the entire population of the earth, except those who believed in Allah's servant and Messenger Nuh, peace be upon him, m Aj-Tabari 14:342.

and 'Ad}, who perished with the barren wind when they rejected Hud, peace be upon him, 4and Thamud}, who were overtaken by the Sayhah (awful cry) when they denied Salih, peace be upon him, and killed the camel, and the people of Ibrahim}, over whom He gave Ibrahim victory and the aid of clear miracles. Allah destroyed their king Nimrod, son of Canaan, son of Koch from Canaan, may Allah

curse him, and the dwellers of Madyan}, the people of Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, who were destroyed by the earthquake and the torment of the day of the Shade, and the overturned cities}, the people of Lut who used to live in Madyan. Allah said in another Ayah, and He destroyed the overturned cities [53:53], meaning the people of the overturned cities in reference to Sadum [Sodom], their major city. Allah destroyed them all because they rejected Allah's Prophet Lut, peace be upon him, and because they committed the sin that none before them had committed [homosexuality] and to them came their Messengers with clear proofs., and unequivocal evidence, So it was not Allah Who wronged them}, when He destroyed them, for He established the proofs against them by sending

Surah 9. At-Tawbah (70 - 71) (Part-10) the Messengers and dissipating the doubts, but they used to wrong themselves on account of their denying the Messengers and defying the Truth; this is why they earned the end, torment and punishment, that they did. > rojl fa V & Si la^ w Sjfc 471. The believers, men and women, are supporters of one another; they enjoin good, and forbid evil ; they perform the Salah, and give the Zakah, and obey Allah and His Messenger. Allah will have His mercy on them. Surely, Allah is All- Mighty, All-Wise.} Qualities of Faithful Believers After Allah mentioned the evil characteristics of the hypocrites, He then mentioned the good qualities of the believers, iof. fa. oUVtf iThe believers, men and women, are supporters of one another;} they help and aid each other. Surely, an authentic Hadith states, ^ -j J (1)UJ IS i ® < 77ie believer to the believer is just like a building, its parts support each other. and the Prophet jg crossed his fingers together. 1 ' 1 In the Sahih it is recorded, yS-" d ^pI-C The example of the believers in the compassion and mercy they FathAl-Bdri 10:464.

472. Allah has promised the believers - men and women, - Gardens under which rivers flow to dwell therein forever, and beautiful mansions in gardens of 'Adn (Eden; Paradise). But the greatest bliss is the good pleasure of Allah. That is the supreme success.) GoodNews for the Believers ofEternal Delight Allah describes the joys and eternal delight He has prepared for the believers, men and women in, i'Q, 'Jr*'^ Oi ct/P iGardens under which rivers flow to dwell therein forever for eternity, and beautiful mansions), built beautifully in good surroundings. In the Two SahDis, it is recorded that Abu Musa, 'Abdullah bin Qays Al-Ash'ari said that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, Sm* ««Sj V^3 Ji VMM f\$\\ 'Two gardens, their pots and whatever is in them are made of gold, and two gardens, their pots and whatever is in them are made of silver. Only the Veil of Pride ofAllah's Face separates the peoplefrom gazing at Him, in the garden ofEden.d 1 ' He also narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, j. %s '5*>4 jifij jjJj j* !>!» •Liijy p Jji V •For the believer in Paradise there is a tent like a hollow pearl which is sixty miles high in the sky, and in the tent the believer will have (so large) a family that he visits them all and some of them would not be able to see the others .» The Two Sahths collected this Hadith.^ It is recorded in the ^ FathAl-B&ri8 :49 1 and Muslim 1 :163. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 8 :44 1 and Muslim 4 :2182

Two Sahih that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, <Jl>-Ju jf ill jU ll>- ijLJiaj >Li_) i)L yi J>-j Ij : IjJli iij ^ ^ jiJiftUiIU ill lale-i &J1 ^ o!' :Jl» ^^Ul :^bu ii '^L i* *UiJiy us j* jS *5jjj lilfjl jl^il **?J ItLfcJl *1>Jl <0ji «H7ioeyer believes in Allah and His Messenger, offers prayer perfectly and fasts the month of Ramadan, will rightfully be granted Paradise by Allah, no matter whether he emigrates in Allah's cause, or remains in the land where he is bom.» The people said, "O Allah's

Messenger! Shall we acquaint the people with this good news?" He said, "Paradise has one- hundred grades which Allah has prepared for the Mujahidin who fight in His cause, the distance between each two grades is like the distance between the heaven and the earth. So, when you ask Allah, ask Him for Al-Pirdaws which is the best and highest part of Paradise, from it gush forth the rivers of Paradise and above it is the 'Arsh (Throne) of the Beneficent V 1 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said. :Jli ?il_ ^Jl Uj ill J^ -j L Jj ill \jLj ij. j Jllj lij ty ll 'jjS if y-jVj J^ \j Jf 'j 1^ 'IL; i iffd 1J -Jr'fi J*f» iff you invoke Allah for Salah (blessings) on me, then also invoke Him to grant me Al-Wasilah .» He was asked, "What is Al-Wasdah, O Allah's Messenger?" He said, iThe highest grade in Paradise, it will be for only one man, and I hope I am that man.*™ The Musnad. contains a Hadith from Sa'd bin Mujahid At- Ta'I, that Abu Al-Mudillah said, that Abu Hurayrah said, "We said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Talk to us about Paradise, what is 111 FathAl-Bari6:\4. Ahmad 2:256.

473 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (72) (Part-10) it built of?' He said, yj lajLJu-j dlUl l i <Jai £Sj > s>i v_r*! 7_> ^ Jlij Y j*jCJ tfU-Jb «i'Li «\ brick of gold and a brick of silver. Its mortar is from musk, its gravel is pearls and rubies. Its sand is saffron. Whoever enters it will enjoy the delights, will never be hopeless, and will live forever and will not die. His clothes will never decay nor will his youth ever end Allah said next, iBut the greatest bliss is the good pleasure of Allah\9:72\, meaning, Allah's pleasure is more grand, greater and better than the delight the believers will be enjoying [in Paradise). Imam Malik narrated, that Zayd bin Aslam said that 'Ata' bin Yasar said that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah said, Hjj I jjijals «1>J! U Lj>Sl dyi* j yp jl# y'j ^ ^ 'y 7 & Uj : ofjjCj Ja . kiiiJb J> yi |*^dapf Yl ! y* |JL>I Ja*3 U Uxlp-i ^ <!M j* tCs* Qo 4o ^ '-ofyS oJLaj Ja^wl «Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, will say to the people of Paradise, 'O residents of Paradise!' They will say, 'Labbayka (here we are!), our Lord, and Sa'dayk (we are happy at your service!) and all the good is in Your Hand.' He will ask them, 'Are you pleased?' They will say, 'Why would not we be pleased, O Lord, while You have given us what You have not given any other of your creation?' He will say, 'Should I give you what is better than all this?' They will say, 'O Lord! What is better than all this?' He will say, 7 will grant you My pleasure and will never afterwards be angry with you.' ^ Ahmad 2:304.

tfeSlgUJr « a 6 lA*j ^ubi^i^==jJ&il^ij)isl^j i jIsa LW ^i^iJ^ Ojj 4Jlla^ie- (>. ^Uj > > * > . * <,,» <. \J" \< s^4 -^JiK I >L".v'£ •; rf The Two Sahihs collected the Haddth of Malik. 4 ?if .It jli£=i)l J^i. ^Jl (!!)?* -tli?) Lni^ll'j ^>J* Jij i> ^ij i_3(i c it l>J ^5^ -1 ^A» a jU^il iS Vi \$2 /«r V 1^" if 1 , * < 1^* *i« L)J» .4M» ui at te ^ h « Lleftj aiiT 4q 1 c& 'tfj \$5 uj 'wi'j^ i| A 473. O Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be harsh against them, their abode is Hell, - and worst indeed is that destination.} 474. They swear by Allah that they said nothing (bad), but really they said the word of disbelief, and they disbelieved after accepting Islam, and they resolved that (plot) which they were unable to carry out, and they could not find any cause to do so except that Allah and His Messenger had enriched them of His bounty. If then they repent, it will be better for them, but if they turn away ; Allah will punish them with a painful torment in this worldly life and in the Hereafter. And there is none for them on earth as a protector or a helper.} The Order for Jihad against the Disbelievers and Hypocrites Allah commanded His Messenger jg to strive hard against the Fath Al-B&ri 1 1 :423 and Muslim 4 : 2176.

disbelievers and the hypocrites and to be harsh against them. Allah also commanded him to be merciful with the believers who followed him, informing him that the destination of the disbelievers and hypocrites is the Fire in the Hereafter. Ibn Mas'ud commented on Allah's statement, {Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites} "With the hand, or at least have a stern face with them." Ibn 'Abbas said, "Allah commanded the Prophet to fight the disbelievers with the sword, to strive against the hypocrites with the tongue and annulled lenient treatment of them."*21 Ad-Dahhak commented, "Perform Jihad against the disbelievers with the sword and be harsh with the hypocrites with words, and this is the Jihad performed against them."*3 * Similar was said by Muqatil and Ar-Rabi'.*4 * Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, "Striving against them includes establishing the (Islamic Penal) Law of equality against them."*5 ' In combining these statements, we could say that Allah causes punishment of the disbelievers and hypocrites with all of these methods in various conditions and situations, and Allah knows best.

what is available to them - so they mock at them (believers);

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2352–2385]

Allah will throw back their mockery on them, and they shall 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :1 11 and Muslim 1 : 78.

482 Tafsir Ibn Kathir have a painful torment.} Hypocrites defame Believers Who give the Little Charity They can afford Among the traits of the hypocrites is that they will not leave anyone without defaming and ridiculing him in all circumstances even those who give away charity. If, for instance, someone gives away a large amount, the hypocrites say that he is showing off. If someone gives away a small amount they say that Allah stands not in need of this man's charity. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ubaydullah bin Sa'd said that Abu An-Nu'man Al-Basri said that Shubah narrated that Sulayman said that Abu Wa'il said that Abu Mas'ud said, "When the verses of charity were revealed, we used to work as porters. A man came and distributed objects of charity in abundance and they (hypocrites) said, 'He is showing off.' Another man came and gave a Sa' (a small measure of food grains); they said, 'Allah is not in need of this small amount of charity.' Then the Ayah was revealed; iThose who defame the volunteers...}^ Muslim collected this Hadith in the SahihJ2 ' Al-'Awfi narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "One day, the Messenger of Allah went out to the people and called them to bring forth their charity, and they started bringing their charity. Among the last to come forth was a man who brought a Sa' of dates, saying, 'O Allah's Messenger! This is a Sa' of dates. I spent the night bringing water and earned two Sa' of dates for my work. I kept one Sa' and brought you the other Sa'.' The Messenger of Allah ordered him to add it to the charity. Some men mocked that man, saying, 'Allah and His Messenger are not in need of this charity. What benefit would this Sa' of yours bring?' 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf asked Allah's Messenger jg, 'Are there any more people who give charity?' The Messenger of Allah said, 111 Path Al-Bari 3 :332 Muslim 2:706.

jl;^ "None besides you!" 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf said, 'I will give a hundred Uqiyah of gold as a charity.' Umar bin Al-Khattab said to him, 'Are you crazy?' 'Abdur-Rahman said, 'I am not crazy.' Umar said, 'Have you given what you said would give?' 'Abdur-Rahman said, 'Yes. I have eight thousand [Dirhams], four thousand I give as a loan to my Lord and four thousand I keep for myself.'

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{U}_{ij} \text{ oSLlif LLi kLU iul djC}$ *May Allah bless you far what you kept and what you gave away*. However, the hypocrites defamed him, *By Allah! ‘Abdur-Rahman gave what he gave just to show off.’ They lied, for ‘Abdur-Rahman willingly gave that money, and Allah revealed about his innocence and the innocence of the fellow who was poor and brought only a Sa‘ of dates. Allah said in His Book, $s | < jj \text{ ot iTlwse who defame such of the believers who give clwrity voluntarily} > (9:79).$ ”¹ > A similar story was narrated from Mujahid and several others. Ibn Ishaq said, “Among the believers who gave away charity were ‘Abdur-Rahman bin ‘Awf who gave four thousand Dirhams and ‘Asim bin ‘Adi from Bani ‘Ajlan. This occurred after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ encouraged and called for paying charity. ‘Abdur-Rahman bin ‘Awf stood and gave away four thousand Dirhams. ‘Asim bin ‘Adi also stood and gave a hundred Wasaq of dates, but some people defamed them, saying, They are showing off.’ As for the person who gave the little that he could afford, he was Abu ‘Aqil, from Bani Anfal Al- Arashi, who was an ally of Bani ‘Amr bin ‘Awf. He brought a Sa‘ of dates and added it to the charity. They laughed at him, saying, ‘Allah does not need the Sa‘ of Abu ‘Aqil.”¹²¹ At-Tabari 14:383. (21 These narrations are not authentic, however, there is a similar narration recorded by Al-Bazzaz that has a minor deficiency in its chain of narration . It could be used as a witness for it , Allah knows best. See Al-Majma no 1 1048

J Allah said, $\wedge j \text{ k}^* \sim -.1 \text{ 4} | \text{rJ 'jy}^* \text{ jnH } \bullet \text{ j-V'— -Ay-JJ } \wedge \text{Xj}$ “ iso they mock at them / $> \wedge \text{t' '}$ • $< * > \text{'}$ (believers); Allah will $\text{G}^* - * \text{ lJ} \wedge \text{r}$ ” 4 $** - >$ throw back their mockery on them $\wedge \& \& \text{h} \wedge \text{kaA} \wedge \text{SL} \&$ Lebukin, $\ll '$ hem fo $\text{Iy} \wedge >$ ‘VCT their evil actions and defaming the $\wedge > \text{r} - * \text{V " f} - "$ believers. Truly, the ‘Lr’r reward, or $\text{I' / V } \wedge \text{ a} > < 1 \text{ i}^* - > * \text{ it f} - * < * \bullet \text{'k}^* > :-$ punishment, is equitable to the $\text{ijJbiU}^v > \text{J}^* \text{L}^u \text{ill}$ action. Allah treated ! people are treated, to aid the believer in Q) prepared a painful $\text{TV} \wedge 4 < \text{"L"} - \text{l} : - \text{"i"} : \text{'! i} \wedge - . \text{r}$ torment in the Hereafter for the $\text{aJjioS} \wedge \text{l}$ hypocrites, for the $\wedge \wedge / \text{r} \gg / \{ . > - \text{i-iMtt'l.t}$ recompense is similar $\text{\textcircled{R}} ||$ to th/deed 480. Whether you (O Muhammad ﷺ) ask forgiveness for them (hypocrites) or ask not forgiveness for them - (and even) if you ask seventy times for their forgiveness - Allah will not forgive them because they have disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger. And Allah guides not those people who are rebellious.> The Prohibition of asking for Forgiveness for Hypocrites Allah says to His Prophet $\text{j}\&\text{E}$ that hypocrites are not worthy of seeking forgiveness for them and that if he asks Allah to forgive them seventy times, Allah will not forgive them. The number seventy here was mentioned to close the door on this subject.

485 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (80 - 81) (Part-10) for Arabs use this number when they exaggerate, not that they actually mean seventy or more than seventy. Ash-Shahi said that when ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy was dying, his son went to the Prophet ﷺ and said to him, “My father has died, I wish you could attend him and pray the funeral prayer for him.” The Prophet ﷺ said, $\text{i} > \ll$ “What is your name?” He said, “Al-Hubab bin ‘Abdullah.” The Prophet said, $\bullet \text{jkl} \text{i vJjUAJI jl J 4l1jLp}$ ‘Rather, you are ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abdullah, for Al-Hubab is a devil's name . The Prophet went along with him, attended his father’s funeral, gave him his shirt as a shroud and prayed the funeral prayer for him. He was asked, “Would you pray on him, when he is a hypocrite?” He said, $\$ \text{hj} \& \text{Sj } 4\% : \text{Jli ii } ! \text{)1 b } \ll$ Allah said, 4 .. .(and even) if you ask seventy times for their forgiveness. Verily, I will ask Allah to forgive them seventy times and seventy more and seventy more. $\text{\textcircled{R}}$ ” * Similar narrations were collected from Thirwah bin Az-Zubayr, Mujahid, Qatadah bin Di‘amah and Ibn Jarir.¹²¹ 481. Those who stayed away (from Tabiik expedition) rejoiced in their staying behind the Messenger of Allah ; they hated to At-Tabari 14:396 l2 ' At-Tabari 14:396-397. Even

But when life ends and they are returned to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, they will start crying forever without end.” 4 ijJojS }l* Jjt IJjc (jf 483. If Allah brings you back to a party of them (the

489Surah 9. At-Tcnvbah (83) (Part-10 hypocrites), and they ask your permission to go out (to fight), say: “Never shall you go out with me nor fight an enemy with me; you were pleased to sit (inactive) on the first occasion, then you sit (ncnv) with those ivho lag behind. Hypocrites are barred from participating in Jihad Allah commands His Messenger, peace be upon him, 41/Allah brings you back), from this battle, Aft 4to a party of them} in reference to the twelve (hypocrite) men, according to Qatadah , 4and they ask your permission to go out}, with you to another battle, if.f ^ di* J A*)’ 4say: “Never shall you go out with me nor fight an enemy with me...”} as an admonishment and punishment for them. Allah mentioned the reason for this decision, A.Yu# 4”You were pleased to sit (inactive) on the first occasion .. .”} Allah said in a similar Ayah, 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time.} (6 :110) The recompense of an evil deed includes being directed to follow it with another evil deed, while the reward of a good deed includes being directed to another good deed after it. For instance, Allah said concerning the ‘Umrah of Hudaibiyyah, 111 At-Tabari 14 :404.

i&jXh 4zm iSi -\$is iThose who lagged behind will say, when you set forth to take the spoils.>[48:15) Allah said next, 4”...then you sit (now) with those who lag behind.”} in reference to the men who lagged behind from [Tabiik) battle, according to Ibn ‘Abbas. iylij !i^ (>rl »iJf*& fS» 484. And never (O Muhammad j&) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies, nor stand at his grave. Certainly they disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger, and died while they were Fasiqun .} The Prohibition of Prayer for the Funeral of Hypocrites Allah commands His Messenger ^ to disown the hypocrites, to abstain from praying the funeral prayer when any of them dies, from standing next to his grave to seek Allah’s forgiveness for him, or to invoke Allah for his benefit. This is because hypocrites disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger jg and died as such. This ruling applies to all those who are known to be hypocrites, even though it was revealed about the specific case of ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin SalQl, the chief hypocrite. Al- Bukhari recorded that Ibn Umar said, “When ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy died, his son, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abdullah, came to the Messenger of Allah jg and asked him to give him his shirt to shroud his father in, and the Messenger did that. He also asked that the Prophet^ offer his father’s funeral prayer, and Allah’s Messenger jg stood up to offer the funeral prayer. Umar took hold of the Prophet’s robe and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Are you going to offer his funeral prayer even though your Lord has forbidden you to do so?’ Allah’s Messenger jg said, m At-Jabari 14:404.

: Jlii iul lj’{fs- U5j» «/ have been given the choice, for Allah says fp& ^^3 oip lip iWhether you ask forgiveness for them (hypocrites), or do not ask for forgiveness for them. Even though you ask for their forgiveness seventy times, Allah will not forgive them.} ‘j.i: " P a Verily, I will ask [for forgiveness for him] more than seventy timesK’ “Umar said, *He is a hypocrite!’ So Allah’s Messenger jg offered the funeral prayer and on that Allah revealed this Verse, if ‘ij Cl ols p A- si’ 4And never (O Muhammad) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies, nor stand at his grave.y*^ Umar bin Al-Khattab narrated a similar narration.12’ In this narration, Umar said, “The Prophet jg offered his funeral prayer, walked with the funeral procession and stood on his grave until he was buried. I was amazed at my daring to talk like this to the Messenger of Allah jg, while Allah and His Messenger jg have better

knowledge. By jg Allah, soon afterwards, these two Ayatwere revealed, 4Q &p if p, 4And never (O Muhammad jg) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies.} Ever since this revelation came, the Prophet jg never offered the funeral prayer for any hypocrite nor stood on his grave until Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, brought death to him.”*3 ‘ At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadlth in his Tafsir (section of his Sunan] and said, “Hasan Sahih”.’4 ‘ Al-Bukhari also recorded it.’ 5’ 111 Fath Al-Bdri 8 :184 [2’ Fath Al-B&ri 8:185. ’3 ‘ Ahmad 1 :16. ’4 ‘ Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :495 |s > Fath Al-B6ri 8:184.

492 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir r-Jj &anfes&gsm T • 2jJijJU_il;;J^y,54i. V. > ^ <j t> ^ ^ «k/ L*->} •>' •A**.X *+•' (>*> pr*1 <3^/J L^jj <85. And let not their wealth or their children amaze you. Allah only wants to punish them with these things in this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.} We mentioned before

the explanation of a similar Ayah, all the thanks and praises are due to Allah. i£*l» ol *Jy* cJ>1 I>Jj} ijji i££3^ £ Ijl# tjj JjiaJ' 4 ••\$•• ^ >4* TJ>^* d® £yJ»J ^ |y£^i o\ jjiy >jj Sj£4^r9^y*x>jA J_p l^k=d|4t \fjjolj^>j*£-^(rijs^£ii_y J ^ ,<L\$J 1 <86. And ivhen a Surah is revealed, enjoining them to believe in Allah and to strive hard and fight along with His Messenger, the wealthy among them ask your leave to exempt them and say, "Leave us (behind), we would be with those who sit (at home)."} 487. They are content to be with those who sit behind. Their hearts are sealed up, so they understand not.} Admonishing ThoseWho did not join the Jihad Allah chastises and admonishes those who stayed away from Jihad and refrained from performing it, even though they had the supplies, means and ability to join it. They asked the

Messenger^ for permission to stay behind, saying, 4U&& 4”Leave us (behind), we zvould be with those luho sit (at home)”) thus accepting for themselves the shame of lagging behind with women, after the army had left. If war starts, such people are the most cowardice, but when it is safe, they are the most boastful among men. Allah described them in another Ayah, liji opl Si cA SAi 4III. ill \$\$\$ 4Then when fear conies, you will see them looking to you, their eyes revolving like (those of) one over whom hovers death; but when the fear departs, they will smite you with sharp tongues.}[33:\9\ their tongues direct their harsh words against you, when it is safe to do so. In battle, however, they are the most cowardice among men. Allah said in another Ayah, oVj JLzj)' vjj, SSca SSS' bji Sj, vji SL/S itli. .V.jLp ijS ojP' iri St joJ' jS yyS 3 Op 4^3^ P*- S&S ijfi jft _P>V' !>_>& 'iji jpj iThose who believe say: "1Why is not a Surah sent down (for us)? But when a decisive Surah (explaining and ordering things) is sent down, and fighting is mentioned therein, you will see those in whose hearts is a disease looking at you with a look of one fainting to death. But it was better for them. Obedience (to Allah) and good words (were better for them). And when the matter is resolved on, then if they had been true to Allah, it would have been betterfor them.) [47:20-21] Allah said next, 4'rr£ & iTheir hearts are sealed up) because of their staying away from Jihad and from accompanying the Messenger jg in Allah’s cause,

(o>« iso they understand not.) they neither understand what benefits them so that they perform it nor what hurts them so that they avoid it. 1/3 p uJJj a \pn j_^j(^ Vi iff & sfX ^ iiii jll jti liifjjV 4#^ Bid the Messengerand those who believed with him strove hard andfought with their wealth and their lives. Such are they for whom are the good things, and it is they who will be successful.) i89. For them Allah has prepared Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow, to dwell therein forever. That is the supreme

success.) After Allah mentioned the sins of the hypocrites, He praised the faithful believers and described their reward in the Hereafter, £ !£C m iBut the Messenger and those who believed with him strove hard and fought) until the end of these two Ayat [9:88-89). This describes the qualities, as well as, the reward of faithful believers. Allah said, iSuch are they for whom are the good things), in the Hereafter, in the gardens of Al-Firdaws and the high grades. iil I J-ijA ->' ^Vi SajIUji &-j) v'-i* At u££=» i90. And those who made excuses from the bedouins came asking your permission to exempt them (from the battle), and those who had lied to Allah and His Messenger sat at home (without asking the permission for it); a painful torment will seize those of them who disbelieve.) Allah describes here the condition of the bedouins who lived

around Al-Madinah, who asked for permission to remain behind from Jihad when they came to the Messenger to explain to him their weakness and inability to join the fighting. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn 'Abbas said that they were those who had valid excuses, for Allah said next. 4and those who had lied to Allah and His Messenger sat at home, and did not ask for permission for it; and Allah warned them of painful punishment, 4a painful torment will seize those of them who disbelieve.} \$g c \$ %£\$&% gaaji \$J} gljll t ^ #<£>44 C IA4 % £>£ 491. There is no blame on those who are weak or ill or who find no resources to spend, if they are sincere and true (in duty) to Allah and His Messenger. No means (of complaint) can there be against the doers of good. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 492. Nor (is there blame) on those who came to you to be provided with mounts, when you said: "I can find no mounts for you," they turned back, with their eyes overflowing with tears of grief that they could not find anything to spend.} 493. The means (of complaint) is only against those who are rich, and yet ask exemption. They are content to be with (the women) who sit behind (at home) and Allah has sealed up their hearts so that they know not (what they are losing).} Legitimate Excuses for staying away from Jihad Allah mentions here the valid excuses that permit one to stay away from fighting. He first mentions the excuses that remain with a person, the weakness in the body that disallows

one from Jihad, such as blindness, limping, and so forth. He then mentions the excuses that are not permanent, such as an illness that would prevent one from fighting in the cause of Allah, or poverty that prevents preparing for Jihad. There is no sin in these cases if they remain behind, providing that when they remain behind, they do not spread malice or try to discourage Muslims from fighting, but all the while observing good behavior in this state, just as Allah said, - tils, pit* c , / s.s * \ • Ji J6 4No means (of complaint) can there be against the doers of good. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Al-Awzal said, "The people went out for the Istisqa (rain) prayer. Bilal bin Sa'd stood up, praised Allah and thanked Him then said, 'O those who are present! Do you concur that wrong has been done?' They said, Yes, by Allah!' He said, 'O Allah! We hear your statement, 4No means (of complaint) can there be against the doers of good.) O Allah! We admit our errors, so forgive us and give us mercy and rain.' He then raised his hands and the people also raised their hands, and rain was sent down on them."* 11 Mujahid said about Allah's statement, j\y\ Z \i\ (f. %) 4Nor (is there blame) on those who came to you to be provided with mounts) Mujahid said; "It was revealed about Bani Muqarrin from the tribe of Muzaynah."12 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Hasan said that the Messenger of Allah said. >S/Ij jij VI iii (2) Ibn Abi Hatim 6 :1862 At-Tabari 14:421

497 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (93 - 94) (Part-11) ^ iSSaljiis T-T ©SSBP iSjC. b\jjj5p=iJ J k K-r ^ ^ »* * >r^ ! y'==,*j*b— pfl(irrc •:. -t- 1 f < i <<*S01L£pZ\$K «Some people have remained behind you in Al-Madinah ; and you never spent anything, crossed a valley, or afflicted hardship on an enemy, but they were sharing the reward with you .» He then recited the Ayah, Z V dJi iNor (is there blame) on those who came to you to be provided with mounts, when you said: "I can find no mounts for j/oh.'V 1 ' This Hadith has a basis in the Two Sahihs from Anas, the Messenger of Allah sg said, J(*-^** p-^J VI I jy- 1 p-j j UjIj li \jt\ji\ oJu>J j jl> “Some people have remained behind in Al-Madinah and you never crossed a valley or marched forth, but they were with you . They said, “While they are still at Al-Madinah?” He said, a 9 *h * 9 «* " • 'm J-Wl j»..g j**J» «Yes, as they have been held back by a (legd) excused Then, Allah criticized those who seek permission to remain 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 6:1863. I2 ' Path Al-B&ri 7 : 732 and Muslim : 1911.

499 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (94 - 96) (Part-11) 4Allah has already informed us of the news concerning you. Allah has exposed your news to us, 4Allah and His Messenger will observe your deeds.) your actions will be made public to people in this life, 4'o& 2? ^ dl f) 4In the aid you will be brought back to the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen, then He (Allah) will inform you of what you used to do.) Allah will inform you of your deeds, whether they were good or evil, and will recompense you for them. Allah said that the hypocrites will swear to the believers in apology, so that the believers turn away from them without admonishing them. Therefore, Allah ordered disgracing them by turning away from them, for they are,)Rijs) meaning, impure inwardly and in their creed. Their destination in the end will be Jahannam, fSJf VjiC K%) 4a recompense for that which they used to earn.) of sins and evil deeds. Allah said that if the believers forgive the hypocrites when they swear to them, 4certainly Allah is not pleased with the people who are Fasiqin.) who rebel against the obedience of Allah and His Messenger Sg. 'Fisq\ means, 'deviation'. % &&& t i£& \$

497. The bedouins are the worst in disbelief and hypocrisy, and more likely to not know the limits which Allah has revealed to His Messenger. And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise. 498. And of the bedouins there are some who look upon what they spend (in Allah's cause) as a fine and watch for calamities for you, on them be the calamity of evil. And Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} 499. And of the bedouins there are some who believe in Allah and the Last Day, and look upon what they spend (in Allah's cause) as means of nearness to Allah, and a cause of receiving the Messenger's hwoctions . Indeed these (expenditures) are a means of nearness for them. Allah will admit them to His mercy. Certainly Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Bedouins are the Worst in Disbelief and Hypocrisy Allah states that there are disbelievers, hypocrites and believers among the bedouins. He also states that the disbelief and hypocrisy of the bedouins is worse and deeper than the disbelief and hypocrisy of others. They are the most likely of being ignorant of the commandments that Allah has revealed to His Messenger jg. Al-A'mash narrated that Ibrahim said, “A bedouin man sat next to Zayd bin Sawhan while he was speaking to his friends. Zayd had lost his hand during the battle of Nahawand. The bedouin man said, Tty Allah! I like your speech. However, your hand causes me suspicion.’ Zayd said, “Why are you suspicious because of my hand, it is the left hand [that is cut)?’ The bedouin man said, Tty Allah! 1 do not know which hand they cut off (for committing theft), is it the right or the left?’ Zayd bin Sawhan said, ‘Allah has said the truth, &# \$ Z& <\$£** Hi 4The bedouins are the worst in disbelief and hypocrisy, and more

likely to not know the limits which Allah has revealed to His Messenger.}’^ Imam Ahmad narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said, m At-Tabari 14:429.

JIUL. . l l j*j ijle- jliJl j*-" ir «He who lives in the desert becomes hard-hearted, he zuho follows the game becomes heedless, and he who associates with the rulers falls into FitnahJ 11 ’ Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa’i collected this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib.’^ The Prophet once had to give a bedouin man many gifts because of what he gave him as a gift, until the bedouin became satisfied. The Prophet s& said, •^S j\ JouJi j\ ji JA V! Jji M ji JLSJb </ almost decided not to accept a gift except from someone from Quraysh, Thaqafi, the Ansar or Daius. n|3 This is because these people lived in cities, Makkah, At- Ta’if, Al-Madlnah and Yemen, and therefore, their conduct and manners are nicer than that of the hard-hearted bedouins. Allah said next, 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.} Allah knows those who deserve to be taught faith and knowledge, He wisely distributes knowledge or ignorance, faith or disbelief and hypocrisy between His servants. He is never questioned as to what He does, for He is the All-Knower, All- Wise. Allah also said that among bedouins are those, c & iiuho look upon what they spend}, in the cause of Allah, ias a fine}, as a loss and a burden, £\$&£20& iand ivatch for calamities for you}, awaiting afflictions and 111 Ahmad 1:357. Abu Dawud 3 :278 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :532 and An-Nasal 7 :195 131 An-NasSl 6:280.

502 Tafsir Ibtî Kathfr Y-r smmm disasters to strike *5 yi*/ . ^ *. > >-"f £*£\j^ajj(yrf£' <Ui i 0^SK*2£ v5-L>-*ft? >« —‘(H «*«' # !»>.< si<-i .% "\>t s' *-s ". y" »rj_^.o><ui i yjr^ls**>j>-'6._) ilj>Lu>ui you, 4o« item be the calamity of evil}, evil will touch them instead, <x-£y«» 4And Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} Allah hears the invocation of His servants and knows who deserves victory, who deserve failure. Allah’s said; ^LjS. 6 £ -tj\$J \$i m ffs' 'X < '*K > . > &y**J 411' XJ> 4And o/ the bedouins there are some who be- lieve in Allah and the Last Day, and look upon what they spend (in Allah's cause) as means of nearness to Allah, and a cause of receiving the Messenger's invocations This is the type of praiseworthy bedouins. They give charity in Allah’s cause as way of achieving nearness to Allah and seeking the Messenger’s invocation for their benefit, 4’s ' s < t*1ss .s \t"> '•1A\ sl^ijObiJwa)'-Vi-Ljto 4il' l)> &Zte£Zt&IJS0i*,y4#<2'& ilndeed these are a means ofnearnessfar them.} they will attain what they sought, ijt -4 i> •?< fi c ;>{, »>/lly& Oj^ rA^t-j J| -Oil > 4-U X; iAlldh will admit them to His mercy. Certainly Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.}

(*T* <dsfj it OjSjVf 5y_£]f^ jyJ' Ijil t,j ilfiVf \Z\~£. iSj~jfs y^T ^ X-4> *lfr i^ijj 4200 . And the foremost to embrace Islam of the Muhdjirin and the Ansar and also those who fallowed them exactly (in faith). Allah is well-pleased with them as they are well-pleased with Him. He has prepared far them Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell therein forever. That is the supreme success. Virtues ofthe Muhajirin, AnsarandThoseWho followed Them in Faith Allah mentions that He is pleased foremost with the Muhdjirin, Ansar and those who followed them in faith, and that they are well-pleased with Him, for He has prepared for them the gardens ofdelight and eternal joy. Ash-Shahi said that, <&%U&&U S&V(sfuZIS» iTheforemost Muhdjirin and Ansar} are those who conducted the pledge of Ar-Ridwan in the year of Hudaibiyah . Abu Milsa Al-Ash’ari, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Muhammad bin Sirin, Al- Hasan and Qatadah said that they are thosewho performed the prayer towards the two Qiblahs with the Messenger of Allah (first toward Jerusalem and later toward the Ka’bah\p^ Allah, the Most Great, stated that He is pleased foremost with the Muhajirin, the Ansar and those who

followed their lead with excellence. Therefore, woe to those who dislike or curse them, or dislike or curse any of them, especially their master after the Messenger, the best and most righteous among them, the Siddiq (the great truthful one) and the grand Khalifah, Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhafah, may Allah be pleased with him. The failure group, the Rafidah (a sect of Shiites), are the enemies of the best Companions, they hate and curse them, we seek refuge with Allah from such evil. This indicates that the minds of these people are twisted and their hearts turned upside m AMabaii 14:435. At-Tabari 14:436, 437, 439.

504 Tafsir Ibt Kathfr down, for where are they in relation to believing in the Qur'an? They curse those whom Allah stated He is pleased with! As for the followers of the Sunnah, they Eire pleased with those whom Allah is pleased with, curse whomever Allah and His Messenger Sg curse, and give their loyalty to Allah's friends and show enmity to the enemies of Allah. They are followers not innovators, imitating (the Sunnah] they do not initiate it on their own. They are indeed the party of Allah, the successful, and Allah's faithful servants. "u -j 4&< £ 1A? Stj -i>Vf i: 'G* 4 f -iHr4 (*+***> Cj*1 ilOl. And among the bedouins around you, some are hypocrites, and so are some among the people of Al-Madmah who persist in hypocrisy; you know them not, We know them. We shall punish them twice, and thereafter they shall be brought back to a great (horrible) torment.} Hypocrites among the Bedouins and Residents of Al- Madinah Allah informs His Messenger, peace be upon him, that among the bedouins around Al-Madlnah there are hypocrites and in Al-Madlnah itself, those, iwho persist in hypocrisy;} meaning they insisted on hypocrisy and continued in it Allah's statement, 'j* >uLi ") } iyou know them not. We know them}, does not contradict His other statement, j jJj} iHad We willed, We could have shown them to you, and you should have known them by their marks; but surely, you will know them by the tone of their speech!}[47:30], because the latter Ayah describes them by their characteristics, not that the Messenger knows all those who

have doubts and hypocrisy. The Messenger jg knew that some of those who associated with him from the people of Al- Madinah were hypocrites, and he used to see them day and night [but did not know who they were exactly]. We mentioned before in the explanation of, i...and they resolved that (plot) which they were unable to carry out...\$[9:74] that the Prophet jg informed Hudhayfah of the names of fourteen or fifteen hypocrites. This knowledge is specific in this case, not that the Messenger of Allah jg was informed of all their names, and Allah knows best. 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah commented on this Ayah (9:101), "What is the matter with some people who claim to have knowledge about other people, saying, 'So-and-so is in Paradise and so-and-so is in the Fire.' If you ask any of these people about himself, he would say, "I do not know (if I will end up in Paradise or the Fire)! Verily, you have more knowledge of yourself than other people. You have assumed a job that even the Prophets before you refrained from assuming. Allah's Prophet Nuh said, 4 i iAnd what knowledgehave I ofwhat they used to do?\$(26: 112] Allah's Prophet Shu'ayb said, iViat which is left by Allah for you (after giving the rights of the people) is better for you, ifyou are believers. And / am not a guardian over you\$[\ 1 :86], while Allah said to His Prophet jg, iyou knoio them not, We know them .^ Mujahid said about Allah's statement, m 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :285.

4We shall punish them twice}, "By killing and capture." In another narration he said, "By hunger and torment in the grave, 5* ft iand thereafter they shall be brought back to a great (horrible) torment.}

‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “The torment in this life strikes their wealth and offspring,” and he recited this Ayah, 40:41 & 42:41. So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; Allah only wants to punish them with these things in the life of this world.} [9:55] These afflictions torment them, but will bring reward for the believers. As for the torment in the Hereafter, it is in the Fire, 10:27-28. And (there are) others who have acknowledged their sins, they have mixed a deed that was righteous with another that was evil. Perhaps Allah will turn unto them in forgiveness. Surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Some Believers stayed away from Battle because They were Lazy After Allah explained the characteristics of the hypocrites who stayed away from battle because they sought to avoid it out of denial and doubt, He then mentioned the disobedient who stayed away from Jihad due to laziness and preferring comfort, even though they truly believed. Al-Tabari 14:442. ^ Al-Tabari 14:444.

ih/h 4 And others who have acknowledged their sins,} These people admitted their error to themselves and their Lord. They had performed good deeds before, as well as, this evil deed that they committed. For them there was forgiveness and pardon of Allah. This Ayah is general, covering all sinners who combine good and evil deeds, thus becoming partly impure, even though it was revealed about some people in specific. Ibn ‘Abbas said that, } And (there are) others}, refers to Abu Lubabah and some of his friends who stayed away from the battle of Tabuk and the Messenger of Allah jg. When the Messenger of Allah jg returned from that battle, this group, Abu Lubabah and five, seven or nine with him, tied themselves to the pillars of the Masjid and refused to let anyone untie them except the Messenger of Allah sg. When this Ayah was revealed, j, ~v Tp-r-V-H u •Jir-’v? i And (there are) others who have acknowledged their sins,} the Messenger of Allah jg untied them and pardoned them.”111 Al-Bukhari recorded that Samurah bin Jundub said that the Messenger of Allah0 said to us, Ullii* iJu jS, jLjii jCl iljlll ^ ** Jtfj t’-f- tj—ll aUi ** !_>*} j jtiy *-Ui I i I dj :*!fU «.Jjjjii Isij si* ^J-\ ^ IjjUi UJU> ^4^ 4E_i *)a^j jZj- \y’s J,A\ ’4>\ \7L.>Vj sLast Night, two (angels) came to me (in a vision) and took me !1 At-Tabari 14:437. This narration is not authentic. There is a similar Mursal narration from Said bin Al-Musayyib in Dala’il An- Nubuwwah

to a city, built with bricks made of gold and silver. We met some men zolto, part of their bodies were as handsome as you ever saw and the part as ugly as you ever saw. The two (angels) ordered these men to go to a river and submerge themselves in it; they did that and came back to us, and the ugliness went away from them, thus becoming the most beautiful form. The two said to me, 'This is the garden of Eden, and this is your residence in it.' The two said, 'As for the men who had part of their body handsome and part ugly, they have mixed a deed that was righteous with another that was evil. Allah has pardoned them.’^ Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in a short form upon the explanation of this Ayah. , \ •>] ^ ^ (yx .X ^/V yi xx . - // . y* Alii J^bj x {jP AjjxJi ^203. Take Sadaqah from their wealth in order to purify them and sanctify them with it, and Salli for them. Verily, your Salat are a Sakan for them; and Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.^ 4104. Know they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants and accepts the Sadaqat, and that Allah alone is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance, Most Merciful?} The Command to collect the Zakah and Its Benefits Allah commanded His Messenger jg to take Sadaqah from the Muslims’ money to purify and sanctify them with it. This Ayah is general, even though some said that it refers specifically to those who mixed good and evil deeds, who admitted to

their errors. Some bedouin later thought that paying Zakah to the Leader was not legislated except to the Messenger sg himself, using this Ayah, as evidence, Vi m Fath Al-Bari 8 : 193

509 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (103 - 104) (Part-11) iTake Sadaqah from their wealth.} Abu Bakr As-Siddiq and other Companions refuted this ill comprehension and fought against them until they paid the Zakah to the Khallfah, just as they used to pay it to the Messenger of Allah jg. As-Siddiq said, “By Allah! If they abstain from paying a bridle that they used to pay to the Messenger of Allah I will fight them for refraining from paying it.” Allah’s statement, ifr-y iand Salli for them}, means, supplicate for them, and ask Allah to forgive them. In the Sahih, Muslim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Abi Awfa said, “Whenever the Prophet jg was brought chanty, he used to invoke Allah for those who brought it. My father also brought his charity and the Prophet jg said, 'J'A J}\$ J* r^ 31 ” «0 Allah! I invoke You for the family of Abu Awfa.^ 2] Allah’s statement, iVerily, your Salat are a Sakan for them}, means, a mercy for them, according to Ibn ‘Abbas.^3 Allah said next, ‘^} iand Allah is All-Hearer,} of your invocation (O Muhammad), iAll-Knower.} in those who deserve your invocation on their behalf, who are worthy of it. Allah said, i^ 'jlXj & 2 3S 3 iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants and accepts the Sadaqdt?} 111 Fath Al-Bari 13 :264 ' Muslim 2 :756 131 At-Jabari 14:457.

510 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir This Ayah encourages reverting to repentance and giving charity, for each of these actions erases, deletes and eradicate sins. Allah states that He accepts the repentance of those who repent to Him, as well as charity from pure resources, for Allah accepts it with His Right Hand and raises it for its giver until even a date becomes as large as Mount Uhud. Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, itji* iixjall Jlij ill jin ojia-i j iilUl jl o Verily, Allah accepts charity, receives it in His Right Hand and develops it far its giver, just as one of you raises his pony, until the bite [offood] becomes as large as Uhud. The Book of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, testifies to this Hadth, iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants and accepts the Sadaqat?}, and, 4U&* 4*W*^ 4Allah will destroy Riba and will give increase for Sadaqat.} 12:276] ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud said, “Charity falls in Allah’s Hand before it falls in the needy’s hand,” he then recited this Ayah, iijj' lAjj ..jCc j* jlit y, ill y IjXiu ffi} 4Know they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants and accepts the Sadaqat?! ill JIAa Si! 4105. And say "Do deeds! Allah will see your deeds, and (so will) His Messenger and the believers. And you will be brought back to the AU-Knower of the unseen and the seen. Then He will inform you of what you used to do."} m At-Tabari 14:460.

Warning the Disobedient Mujahid said that this Ayah carries a warning^ ' from Allah to those who defy His orders. Their deeds will be shown to Allah, Blessed and Most Honored, and to the Messenger and the believers. This will certainly occur on the Day of Resurrection, just as Allah said, }That Day shall you be brought to Judgement, not a secret of you will be hidden .} (69:18], \$0 iThe Day when all the secrets will be examined.}\86:9], and, ^And that which is in the breasts (of men) shall be made known.} [100:10] Allah might also expose some deeds to the people in this life. Al-Bukhari said that ‘Aishah said, “If the good deeds of a Muslim person please you, then say, ilppj fez&aip 4Do deeds! Allah will see your deeds, and (so will) His Messenger and the believers.}’™ There is a Hadith that carries a similar meaning. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah^ said, Z* lilij nJ jU £*Jl jia jilt ^3 .- j/J *i>j> ji - oi; 33 jiJu ;>s^ j&ii Sp ciSi jiJd (J-j ^1^ t I I ojIaj aL jlj'i 4 UxJtJ? J, «.» p-j

jVl]l J^a *5i> “Do not be pleased with someone's deeds until you see what his deeds in the end will be like. Verily, one might work for some At-Jabari 14:463 121 Path Al-Bdri 13:512.

512 Tafsir Ibn Katlur time of his life with good deeds, so that if he dies while doing it, he will enter Paradise. However, he changes and commits evil deeds, one might commit evil deeds for some time in his life, so that if he dies while doing them he will enter the Fire. However, he changes and performs good deeds. If Allah wants the good of a servant He employs him before he dies .» He was asked, “How would Allah employ him, O Allah’s Messenger?” He said, «He directs him to perform good deeds and takes his life in that condition .n Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith. 4106. And others are made to await for Allah's Decree, whether He will punish them or will forgive them. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise. Delaying the Decision about the Three Companions Who stayed away from the Battle of Tabuk Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and several others said that those mentioned in the Ayah are the three who were made to wait to know if their repentance was accepted; Mararah bin Ar-Rabl’, Ka’b bin Malik and Hilal bin Umayyah. Some Companions stayed behind from the battle of Tabuk due to laziness, preferring comfort, ease, ripe fruits and shade. They did not lag behind because of hypocrisy or doubts. Some of them tied themselves to the pillars (of the Masjid) like Abu Lubabah and several of his friends did. Some of them did not do that, and they are the three mentioned here. Those who tied themselves received their pardon before these three men whose pardon was delayed, until this Ayah was revealed, 4Alldh has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajir and the Ansar. m Ahmad 3 : 120

r^ T • i msm ^ jv^I^i^Ll4S1lj I^UiJli ill ; > < i^" { * ^ t^w t . c . ^^ 1^1 *" j-t n^s <jlv^ - „ul^J U-j^u-3 jl ^ 'A ^ r^U^i i^r.f^ ^^ 4jj^< lit &. i# £&f £> 4#5c tin^xx iAnd the three who stayed behind, until for them the earth, vast as it is, was straitened ...^ We will mention the Hadith about this story from Ka’b bin Malik. Allah said, <whether He will punish them or will forgive them.} meaning, they are at Allah’s mercy, if He wills, He pardons them or punishes them. However, Allah’s mercy comes before His anger, ii££- iX i£fj> iAnd Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} [9:106] Allah knows those who deserve the punishment and those who deserve the pardon. He is All-Wise in His actions and statements, there is no deity worthy of worship nor Lord besides Him. Xr’J*. XjSA X?. j>4=»J XX XsJ’j} ^ 17) % l&3i; ‘j5 « fez & ^ -X>y^ - is-i i~j p*-3 J >iJ o; ifjiii u~*l jL ,*.li liSl *_j i.^fXx&Xu% il07. And as for those who put up a Masjid by way of harm At-Tabari 14:465-466.

and disbelief and to disunite the believers and as an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger aforetime, they will indeed swear that their intention is nothing but good. Allah bears witness that they are certainly liars. \$108. Never stand you therein. Verily, the Masjid whose foundation was laid from the first day on Taqwa is more worthy that you stand therein (to pray). In it are men who love to clean and purify themselves . And Allah loves those who make themselves clean and pure.} Masjid Ad-Dirar and Masjid At-Taqwa

The reason behind revealing these honorable Ayat is that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2385–2397]

before the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) migrated to Al-Madīnah, there was a man from Al-Khazraj called “Abu ‘Amir Ar-Rahib (the Monk).” This man embraced Christianity before Islam and read the

Scriptures. During the time of Jahiliyyah, Abu 'Amir was known for being a worshipper and being a notable person among Al-Khazraj. When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ arrived at Al-Madīnah after the Hijrah, the Muslims gathered around him and the word of Islam was triumphant on the day of Badr, causing Abu 'Amir, the cursed one, to choke on his own saliva and announce his enmity to Islam. He fled from Al-Madīnah to the idolators of Quraysh in Makkah to support them in the war against the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. The Quraysh united their forces and the bedouins who joined them for the battle of Uhud, during which Allah tested the Muslims, but the good end is always for the pious and righteous people. The rebellious Abu 'Amir dug many holes in the ground between the two camps, into one of which the Messenger ﷺ fell, injuring his face and breaking one of his right lower teeth. He also sustained a head injury. Before the fighting started, Abu 'Amir approached his people among the Ansar and tried to convince them to support and agree with him. When they recognized him, they said, "May Allah never burden an eye by seeing you, O Fasiq one, O enemy of Allah!" They cursed him and he went back declaring, "By Allah! Evil has touched my people after I left." The Messenger of Allah ﷺ called Abu 'Amir to Allah and recited the Qur'an to him before his flight to Makkah, but he refused to embrace Islam and rebelled. The Messenger ﷺ invoked Allah

515 Surah 9. At-Ta'ibah (107 - 108) (Part-11 that Abu 'Amir die as an outcast in an alien land, and his invocation came true. After the battle of Uhud was finished, Abu 'Amir realized that the Messenger's call was still rising and gaining momentum, so he went to Heraclius, the emperor of Rome, asking for his aid against the Prophet ﷺ. Heraclius gave him promises and Abu 'Amir remained with him. He also wrote to several of his people in Al-Madīnah, who embraced hypocrisy, promising and insinuating to them that he will lead an army to fight the Messenger of Allah ﷺ to defeat him and his call. He ordered them to establish a stronghold where he could send his emissaries and to serve as an outpost when he joins them later on. These hypocrites built a Masjid next to the Masjid in Quba', and they finished building it before the Messenger ﷺ went to Tabuk. They went to the Messenger ﷺ inviting him to pray in their Masjid so that it would be a proof that the Messenger ﷺ approved of their Masjid. They told him that they built the Masjid for the weak and ill persons on rainy nights. However, Allah prevented His Messenger ﷺ from praying in that Masjid. He ﷺ said to them, «4>1 (j1 j IS) IfZlj JcT tjs- U|D «// we come back from our travel, Allah willing.» When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ came back from Tabuk and was approximately one or two days away from Al-Madīnah, Jibril came down to him with the news about Masjid Ad-Dirar and the disbelief and division between the believers, who were in Masjid Quba' (which was built on piety from the first day), that Masjid Ad-Dirar was meant to achieve. Therefore, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ sent some people to Masjid Ad-Dirar to bring it down before he reached Al-Madīnah. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah (9:107), "They are some people of the Ansar to whom Abu 'Amir said, 'Build a Masjid and prepare whatever you can of power and weapons, for I am headed towards Caesar, emperor of Rome, to bring Roman soldiers with whom I will expel Muhammad and his companions.' When they built their Masjid, they went to the Prophet ﷺ and said to him, "We finished building our Masjid and we would like you pray in it and invoke Allah for us for His blessings." Allah revealed this verse,

iNever stand you therein}, until, 4 . . . wrongdoers} "(11 Allah said next, 4they will indeed swearK those who built it, 4iP>' ! ' Vij\ o|^ that their intention is nothing but good.) by building this Masjid we sought the good and the comfort of the people. Allah replied, 4Allah bears witness that they are

certainly liars for they only built it to harm Masjid Quba', and out of disbelief in Allah, and to divide the believers. They made it an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, such as Abu 'Amir the Fasiq who used to be called Ar- Rahib, may Allah curse him! Allah said, 4Never stand you therein}, prohibiting His Prophet and his Ummah from ever standing in it in prayer. Virtues of Masjid Quba Allah encouraged His Prophet ﷺ to pray in Masjid Quba which, from the first day, was built on Taqwa, obedience to Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, for gathering the word of the believers and as an outpost and a fort for Islam and its people. This is why Allah the Exalted said, 4Verily, the Masjid whose foundation was laid from the first day on Taqwa is more worthy that you stand therein (to pray) ! At-Tabari 14:470. The last two narrations are not authentic. Two of the narrations recorded by At-Tabari confirm much of the story and the cause of revelation

517 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (107 -108) (Part-11 pray).} in reference to the Masjid of Quba'. An authentic Hadith records that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, iOne prayer in Masjid Quba' is just like an ' Umrah.*111 It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah used to visit Masjid Quba' while riding and walking Imam Ahmad recorded that Tirmidhi bin Saldah Al-Ansari said that the Prophet ﷺ went to Masjid Quba' and asked, loi Hi <Cai ^ *Ui3l Jlii Sul jj 1 bj^io jiJl In the story about your Masjid, Allah the Exalted has praised you concerning the purification that you perform. What is the purification that you perform?» They said, “By Allah, O Allah’s Messenger! We do not know except that we had neighbors from the Jews who used to use water to wash with after answering the call of nature, and we washed as they washed.” ,3* Ibn Khuzaymah collected this Hadith in his Sahih Allah’s statement, U%biz iVerily, the Masjid whose foundation was laid from the first day on Taqwa is more worthy that you stand therein (to pray). In it are men who love to clean and purify themselves. And Allah loves those who make themselves clean and pure.} This encourages praying in old Masjids that were built for the purpose of worshipping Allah alone, without partners. It is also recommended to join the prayer with the believing group and worshippers who implement their faith, those who perform *** Ibn Majah 1 :452 and At-Tirmidhi: 324. ^ FathAl-Bdri 3 :82 and Muslim : 1399 Ahmad 3 :422 Ibn Khuzaymah 1 :45

Wudu' perfectly and preserve themselves from impure things. Imam Ahmad recorded that one of the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ led them in a Dawn (Subh) prayer in which he recited Surat Ar-Rum (chapter 30) and made mistakes in the recitation. When he finished the prayer, he said, «We sometimes make mistakes in reciting the Qur'an, there are people among you who attend the prayer with us, but do not perform Wudu' perfectly. Therefore, whoever attends the prayer with us let him make perfect Wudu' This Hadith indicates that complete purification helps in the performance of acts of worship and aids in preserving and completing them. ^ ^ 4>» f' Qy&JJ cr — *-» / j 4 J'>i V fyi* V 4 4109. Is it then he who laid the foundation of his building on Taqwa to Allah and His good pleasure better, or he who laid the foundation of his building on the brink of an undetermined precipice ready to crumble down, so that it crumbled to pieces with him into the fire of Hell. And Allah guides not the people who are the wrongdoers.} 4110. The building which they built will never cease to be a cause of hypocrisy and doubt in their hearts unless their hearts are cut to pieces. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} The Difference between Masjid At-Taawa and Masjid Ad- Dirdr Allah the Exalted says that the Masjid that has been built on the basis of Taqwa of Allah and His pleasure is not the same as a Masjid that was been built based on causing harm, 111 Ahmad 3:471-472.

519 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (109 - 111) (Part-11) disbelief and causing division among the believers, and as an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger 5§|. The latter built their Masjid on the edge of a steep hole, into the fire of Hell. And Allah guides not the people who are the wrongdoers.}, Allah does not bring aright the works of those who commit mischief. Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “I saw the Masjid that was built to cause harm with smoke rising up from it, during the time of the Messenger of Allah jg.” fl! Allah’s statement, 4 ^ ‘ft iThe building which they built will never cease to be a cause of doubt in their hearts} and hypocrisy. Because of this awful action that they committed, they inherited hypocrisy in their hearts, just as those who worshipped the calf were inclined to adoring it. Allah said next, 4unless their hearts are cut to pieces.} until they die, according to Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam, As-Suddi, Habib bin Abi Thabit, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and several other scholars of the Salad.121 4.\$- Stfft \$And Allah is All-Knowing,} of the actions of His creation, 4£-&=£-} iAll-Wise.} in compensating them for their good or evil actions. 4 jdllyS J 4 .. tsjJk \$jt} Cr-J iPiP \ ipe- IJcj \$Laj SjiSj p jrp 111 At-Tabari 14:493. 121 At-Tabari 14:495-497.

4222 . Verily, Allah has purchased of the believers their lives and their properties for (the price) that theirs shall be the Paradise. They fight in Allah's cause, so they kill and are killed. It is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an. And who is truer to his covenant than Allah? Then rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.} Allah has purchased the Souls and Wealth of the Mujahidin in Return for Paradise Allah states that He has compensated His believing servants for their lives and wealth - if they give them up in His cause - with Paradise. This demonstrates Allah’s favor, generosity and bounty, for He has accepted the good that He already owns and bestowed, as a price from His faithful servants. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah commented, “By Allah! Allah has purchased them and raised their worth.”111 Shimr bin ‘Atiyyah said, “There is not a Muslim but has on his neck a sale that he must conduct with Allah; he either fulfills its terms or dies without doing that.” He then recited this Ayah.m This is why those who fight in the cause of Allah are said to have conducted the sale with Allah, meaning, accepted and fulfilled his covenant.131 Allah’s statement, iTheyfight in Alldt's cause, so they kill and are killed.} indicates that whether they were killed or they kill the enemy, or both, then Paradise will be theirs. The Two Sahihs recorded the Hadith, dlj L» dy-a c# ! 4Jl>-Jj ji 0L “Allah has made a promise to the person who goes out (to fight) in His cause; 'And nothing compels him to do so except Jihad = 111 At-Tabari 14:499. 121 At-Tabari 14:499. 131 At-Tabari 14:499.

521 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (111 - 112) (Part-11) igggjjgjj 'W. in My Cause and belief rtiJjjJ.oyaiy-. *4r*,w I >T* (> . :c — 'JLrJ^ eLs^Ljfc -*— •**' '\Ai\ZC5fei^\<Z>te=*£j© 4i\<jj\$!p Jp'-JaU '0£^J>_>*-»-ib_>4Jv_U^ri y_^XjciJOi^~1-^)J £^==^~ ^ -i n >' >?, ^ .1; ^;s -l *-*:~ Swl »_? ^j>-4^ia“i j> {yw-ju>j> g--- in My Messengers.' He u«7/ eif/jer be admitted to Paradise if he dies, or compensated by Allah, either with a reward or booty if He returns him to the home which he departed from.» [l] Allah’s statement, iPpo &• *£ i5£> 41t is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an .} affirms this promise and informs us that Allah has decreed this for His Most Honorable Self, and revealed it to His Messengers in His Glorious Books, the Tawrah that He sent down to Musa, the Injil that He sent down to ‘Isa, and the Qur’an that was sent down to Muhammad, may Allah’s peace and blessings be on them all. Allah said next, <&, Zsj¥ iAnd who is

truer to his covenant than Allah?} affirming that He never breaks a promise. Allah said in similar statements, i^i-jp-p S* ZPf} iAnd who is truer in statement than Allah?}\4:87], and, I1 ' Fath Al-Bari 6 : 254 and Muslim 3 :1496

\$ oi ij iAnd whose words can be truer than those ofAllah?}[4:122]. Allah said next, 4.*Jf**' jyR£ .ij fXf, tSjjJt [fejJJt} iThen rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.}, meaning, let those who fulfill the terms of this contract and uphold this covenant receive the good news of great success and everlasting delight. j ajJfiZII by4=if SjiLift iSjlili 4112. Those who repent, who worship (Him), who praise (Him), who fast, who bow down, who prostrate themselves, who enjoin good andforbid evil, and who observe the limits set by Alldh. And give glad tidings to the believers.} This is the description of the believers from whom Allah has purchased their souls and wealth, who have these beautiful and honorable qualities. 4who repent} from all sins and shun all evils, 4o/^ii} 4who worship}, their Lord and preserve the acts ofworship that include statements and actions. Praising Allah is among the best statements. This is why Allah said next, 4ojJudl} iwho praise (Him)}. Fasting is among the best actions, involving abstaining from the delights of food, drink and sexual intercourse, this is the meaning hereby, 4&4&\} 4As-Sd'ihun (who fast)} [9:112]. Allah also described the Prophet's wives that they are.

iSa'ihdt} [66:5], meaning, they fast. As for prostrating and bowing down, they are acts ofthe prayer, iwho bow down, who prostrate themselves, These believers also benefit Allah's creation and direct them to His obedience by ordaining righteousness and forbidding evil. They have knowledge about what should be performed and what should be shunned. This includes abiding by Allah's limits in knowledge and action, meaning, what He allowed and what He prohibited. Therefore, they worship the True Lord and advise creation. This is why Allah said next, \$And give glad tidings to the believers.} since faith includes all of this, and the supreme success is for those who have faith. b Juo Ji 04? 4^ j!> ! w£-i ii b^ 4123. It is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the Mushrikin, even though they be of kin, after it has become clear to them that they are the dwellers of the Fire (because they died in a state of disbelief.} 4124. And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he [IbrahimJ had made to him (his father). But when it became clear to him [Ibrahim] that he (his father) is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himselffrom him. Verily, Ibrahim was Awwah and forbearing.} The Prohibition ofsupplicating for Polytheists Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Al-Musayyib said that his father Al-Musayyib said, "When Abu Talib was dying, the Prophet 3g went to him and found Abu Jahl and 'Abdullah bin

Abi Umayyah present. The Prophet jfa said, > 4 ^ dU <>!£ lb l «Jl Ji ^{t cO uncle! Say, 'La ilaha illa-llah,' a word concerning which I will pleafor you with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored.» Abu Jahl and 'Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah said, 'O Abu Talib! Would you leave the religion of Abdul-Muttalib?' Abu Talib said, 'Rather, I will remain on the religion of Abdul-Muttalib.'

The Prophet said, •iili- p u Sv «/ will invoke Allah forforgivenessfor you, as long as I am not prohibitedfrom doing soj This verse was revealed, ^ Jt 4^ \y^=* Aj J 5-*'» dyJ'J Jjii) it ilt is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the Mushrikin, even though they be of kin, after it has become clear to them that they are the dwellers of the Fire.)> Concerning Abu Talib, this Ayah was revealed, 4 O' 'Sfr. (i O' tfjVr V iVerily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides

whom He wills} [28:56]. (1) This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahths. (2) Ibn Jarir recorded that Sulayman bin Buraydah said that his father said, "When the Prophet ﷺ came to Makkah, he went to a grave, sat next to it, started talking and then stood up with tears in his eyes. We said, 'O Allah's Messenger! We saw what you did.' He said, jili J . i ijtj j. ^0 ^ Ahmad 5 :433. ^ Fath Al-Bari 8 :192 and Muslim 1 :54

525 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (113 - 114) (Part-11) «/ asked my Lord for permission to visit the grave of my mother and He gave me permission. I asked for His permission to invoke Him for forgiveness for her, but He did not give me permission.» We never saw him more tearful than on that day.'''' Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas about Allah's statement, j j£C deft *4\ O 4/f is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the Mushrikin} "The Prophet ﷺ wanted to invoke Allah for forgiveness for his mother, but Allah did not allow him. The Prophet ﷺ said, jj «!>I J-ii !>• «Ibrahim, Allah's Khalil, invoked Allah for his father.» Allah revealed, 4^1 Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he [Ibrahim] had made to him (his father)).' *2 'Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated that Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, "They used to invoke Allah for them (pagans) until this Ayah was revealed. They then refrained from invoking Allah to forgive the dead among them, but were not stopped from invoking Allah for the living among them until they die. Allah sent this Ayah, 4And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only...} [9:114], '''3 ' Allah said next, m At-Jabari 6:489. ' At-Tabari 14:512. Although this Hadith is weak, there are similar narrations that serve as witnesses for it. See Sahih Sunan At- Tirmidhi no . 2477 '3| At-Jabari 14:513.

<But when it became clear to him [Ibrahim] that he (his father) is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him [9:114], Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Ibrahim kept asking Allah to forgive his father until he died, when he realized that he died as an enemy to Allah, he disassociated himself from him." In another narration, he said, "When his father died he realized that he died as an enemy of Allah."111 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and several others.121 TJBayd bin Umayr and Said bin Jubayr said, "Ibrahim will disown his father on

the Day of Resurrection, but he will meet his father and see

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2397–2402]

dust and fatigue on his face. He will say, 'O Ibrahim! I disobeyed you, but today, I will not disobey you.' Ibrahim will say, 'O Lord! You promised me that You will not disgrace me on the Day they are resurrected. What more disgrace than witnessing my father being disgraced?' He will be told, 'Look behind you,' where he will see a bloody hyena - for his father will have been transformed into that - and it will be dragged from its feet and thrown in the Fire.''''131 Allah's statement, i Verily, Ibrahim was Aivwah and was forbearing. means, he invoked Allah always, according to 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud.141 Several narrations report this from Ibn Mas'ud. 151 It was also said that, 'Awwah', means, "who invokes Allah with humility", 'merciful', *who believes with certainty', 'who praises (Allah)', and so forth. iii i) -djjfci £ H ilu £j» j-4i. K/f} &^ « ffeJ 13IS 4- & 2 # k & iU5. And Allah will never lead a people astray after He has guided them until He makes clear to them what they should avoid. Verily,

Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} At-Tabari 14:519. (2 > At-Tabari 14:518-519. At-Tabari 14:521. At-Tabari 14:523-524. At-Tabari 14:524.

4116. Indeed to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, He gives life and He causes death. And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.} Recompense comes after Proof is established Allah describes His Honorable Self and just judgment in that He does not lead a people astray but after the Message comes to them, so that the proof is established against them. For instance, Allah said, j •> 4And as for Thamud, We showed and made clear to them the path of truth ...} [41:17]. Mujahid commented on Allah's saying; 4And Allah will never lead a people astray after He has guided them} "Allah the Mighty and Sublime is clarifying to the believers about not seeking forgiveness for the idolators in particular, and in general, it is an exhortation to beware of disobeying Him, and encouragement to obey Him. So either do or suffer." Ibn Jarir commented, "Allah says that He would not direct you to misguidance, so that you invoke Him for forgiveness for your dead idolators, after He gave you guidance and directed you to believe in Him and in His Messenger jg! First, He will inform you of what you should avoid, so that you avoid it. Before He informs you that this action is not allowed, you would not have disobeyed Him and fallen into what He prohibited for you [if you indulge in this action]. Therefore, in this case, He will not allow you to be misguided. Verily, guidance or misguidance occurs after commands and prohibitions are established. As for those who were neither commanded nor prohibited, they can neither be obedient nor disobedient in doing what they were neither ordered nor prohibited from doing." 121 111 At-Tabari 14:537. [2! At-Tabari 14:536.

Allah said, indeed to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, He gives life and He causes death. And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.> Ibn Jarir commented, "This is an encouragement from Allah for His believing servants to fight the idolators and chiefs of disbelief. It is also a command for them to trust in Allah's aid, for He is the Owner of the heavens and earth, and not to fear His enemies. Verily, they have no protector besides Allah, nor a supporter other than Him." M li 4117. Allah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress (Tabuk expedition), after the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated (from the right path), but He accepted their repentance. Certainly, He is unto them full of kindness. Most Merciful Battle of Tabuk Mujahid and several others said, "This Ayah was revealed concerning the battle of Tabuk. They left for that battle during a period of distress. It was a year with little rain, intense heat and scarcity of supplies and water. "2 * Qatadah said, "They went to Ash-Sham during the year of the battle of Tabuk at a time when the heat was intense. Allah knew how hard things were, and they suffered great hardship. We were told that two men used to divide a date between themselves. Some of them would take turns in sucking on a date and drinking water, then give it to another man to suck on. Allah forgave them and allowed them to come back from that battle. "31 Ibn Jarir At-Tabari 14:538. At-Tabari 14:540. At-Tabari 14:541.

reported that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said that Umar bin Al- Khattab was reminded of the battle of distress (Tabuk) and Umar said, "We went with the Messenger of Allah jg in the intense heat for Tabuk. We camped at a place in which we were stricken so hard by thirst that we thought that our necks would be severed. One of us used to go out in search of water and did not return until he feared that his neck

would be severed. One would slaughter his camel, squeeze its intestines and drink its content, placing whatever was left on his kidney. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, has always accepted your invocation, so invoke Allah for us.’ The Prophet ﷺ said, “Would you like me to do that?» Abu Bakr said, ‘Yes.’ The Prophet ﷺ raised his hands and did not put them down until rain fell from the sky in abundance. It rained and then stopped raining for a while, then rained again, so they filled their containers. We went out to see where the rain reached and found that it did not rain beyond our camp.”¹¹¹ Ibn Jarir said about Allah’s statement, *Ji »j*~if^4\$ js iil ^>\ iAllah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress,* meaning “With regards to expenditures, transportation, supplies and water, *gjj ^=* £ m)* Rafter the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated,) away from the truth, thus falling prey to doubting the Messenger’s religion because of the distress and hardships they suffered during their travel and battle, *iL# '£) 4* but He accepted their repentance.) He directed them to repent to their Lord and renew their *m* At-Jabari 14:539.

532 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (118 - 119) (Part-11)

the battle of Tabuk with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Ka*b bin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2402–2426]

Malik said, “I did not remain behind Allah’s Messenger ﷺ in any battle that he fought except the battle of Tabuk. I failed to take part in the battle of Badr, but Allah did not admonish anyone who did not participate in it, for in fact, Allah’s Messenger ﷺ had gone out in search of the caravan of Quraysh, until Allah made the Muslims and their enemies meet without any appointment. I witnessed the night of Al-‘Aqabah pledge with Allah’s Messenger ﷺ when we pledged for Islam, and I would not exchange it for the Badr Battle, even though the Badr Battle is more popular among the people than the ‘Aqabah pledge. As for my news of this battle of Tabuk, I was never stronger or wealthier than I was when I remained behind Allah’s Messenger in that battle. By Allah, never had I two she-camels before, but I did at the time of that battle. Whenever Allah’s Messenger ﷺ wanted to go to a battle, he used to hide his intention by referring to different battles, until it was the time of that battle (of Tabuk) which Allah’s Messenger ﷺ fought in intense heat, facing a long journey, the desert, and the great number of enemy soldiers. So the Prophet ﷺ clearly announced the destination to the Muslims, so that they could prepare for their battle, and he told them about his intent. Allah’s Messenger ﷺ was accompanied by such a large number of Muslims that they could not be listed in a book by name, nor registered.” Ka*b added, “Any man who intended not to attend the battle would think that the matter would remain hidden, unless Allah revealed it through divine revelation. Allah’s Messenger fought that battle at a time when the fruits had ripened and the shade was pleasant, and I found myself inclined towards that. Allah’s Messenger ﷺ and his Companions prepared for the battle and I started to go out in order to get myself ready along with them, but I returned without doing anything. I would say to myself, ‘I can do that if I want.’ So I kept on delaying it every now and then until the people were prepared, and Allah’s Messenger and the Muslims along with him, departed. But I had not prepared anything for my departure. I said, ‘I will prepare myself (for departure) one or two days after him, and then join them.’ In the morning following their departure, I went out to get myself ready but returned having

done nothing. Then again, the next morning, I went out to get ready but returned without doing anything. Such was the case with me until they hurried away and I missed the battle. Even then I intended to depart to catch up to them. I wish I had done so! But such was not the case. So, after the departure of Allah's Messenger sSg, whenever I went out and walked among the people (who remained behind), it' grieved me that I could see none around me, but one accused of hypocrisy or one of those weak menwhom Allah had excused. Allah's Messenger jg did not remember me until he reached Tabuk. So while he was sitting among the people in Tabuk, he said, •wuu 4-^ "What did Ka'b bin Malik do?" A man from Banu Salimah said, 'O Allah's Messenger! He has been stopped by his two Burdah (garments) and looking at his own flanks with pride.' Mu'adh bin Jabal said, What a bad thing you have said! By Allah! O Allah's Messenger! We know nothing about him but that which is good.' Allah's Messenger jg kept silent." Ka'b bin Malik added, "When I heard that Allah's Messenger Sg was on his way back to Al-Madlnah, I was overcome by concern and began to think of false excuses. I said to myself, •How can I escape from his anger tomorrow?' I started looking for advice from wise members of my family in this matter. When it was said that Allah's Messenger jg had approached (Al- Madlnah) all evil and false excuses abandoned my mind and I knew well that I could never come out of this problem by forging a false statement. Then I decided firmly to speak the truth. Allah's Messenger jg arrived in the morning, and whenever he returned from a journey, he used to visit the Masjid first, and offer a two Rak'ah prayer, then sit for the people. So when he had done all that (this time), those who failed to join the battle came and started offering (false) excuses and taking oaths before him. They were over eighty men. Allah's Messenger jg accepted the excuses they expressed outwardly, asked for Allah's forgiveness for them and left the secrets of their hearts for Allah to judge. Then I came to him, and when I greeted him, he smiled a smile of an angry person and then said,

"Come sSo Icamewalking until I sat before him. He said to me, dJ>ii Ji jjt iuUuB oWlflf stopped you from joining us? Had you not purchased an animal for carrying you? I answered, "Yes, O Allah's Messenger! By Allah, if I were sitting before any person from among the people of the world other than you, I would have escaped from his anger with an excuse. By Allah, I have been bestowed with the power of speaking fluently and eloquently, but by Allah, I knew well that if I tell you a lie today to seek your favor, Allah would surely make you angry with me in the near future. But if I tell you the truth, though you will get angry because of it, I hope for Allah's forgiveness. By Allah, I had never been stronger or wealthier than I was when I remained behind you.' Allah's Messenger said, .2: , • zc , • - <il I ^ Ijla Ui» «As regards to this man, he has surely told the truth. So get up until Allah decides your case. I got up, and many men of Banu Salimah followed me and said to me, *By Allah, we never witnessed you commit any sin before this! Surely, you failed to offer an excuse to Allah's Messenger sg like the others who did not join him. The invocation of Allah's Messenger to Allah to forgive you would have been sufficient for your sin.' By Allah, they continued blaming me so much that I intended to return (to the Prophet 2fe) and accuse myself of having told a lie, but I said to them, Is there anybody else who has met the same end as I have?' They replied, Yes, there are two men who have said the same thing as you have, and to both of them was given the same order as given to you.' I said, "Who are they?' They replied, 'Murarah bin Ar-Rabf Al-'Amiri and Hilal bin Umayyah Al-Waqifi.' They mentioned to me two pious men who had attended the battle of Badr and in whom there was an example for me. So I did not change my mind when they mentioned them to me. Allah's Messenger sg forbade all the Muslims from

talking to us, the three aforesaid persons, out of all those who remained behind for that battle. So we kept away from the people and they changed their attitude towards us until the very land (where I

534 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir lived) appeared strange to me as if I did not know it. We remained in that condition for fifty nights. As for my two companions, they remained in their houses and kept on weeping, but I was the youngest and the firmest of them. So I would go out and attend the prayer along with the Muslims and roam the markets, but none would talk to me. I would come to Allah's Messenger jg and greet him while he was sitting in his gathering after the prayer, and I would wonder whether he even moved his lips in return of my greeting or not. Then I would offer my prayer near him and look at him carefully. When I was busy with my prayer, he would turn his face towards me, but when I turned my face to him, he would turn his face away from me. When this harsh attitude and boycott of the people continued for a long time, I walked until I scaled the wall of the garden of Abu Qatadah who was my cousin and the dearest person to me. I offered my greeting to him. By Allah, he did not return my greetings. I said, 'O Abu Qatadah! I beseech you by Allah! Do you know that I love Allah and His Messenger?' He kept quiet. I asked him again, beseeching him by Allah, but he remained silent. I asked him again in the Name of Allah and he said, 'Allah and His Messenger know better.' Thereupon my eyes flowed with tears and I returned and jumped over the wall. While I was walking in the market of Al-Madlnah, suddenly I saw that a Nabatean from Ash-Sham came to sell his grains in Al-Madlnah, saying, 'Who will lead me to Ka*b bin Malik?' The people began to point (me) out for him, until he came to me and handed me a letter from the king of Ghassan (who ruled Syria for Caesar), for I knew how to read and write. In that letter, the following was written: 'To proceed, I have been informed that your friend (the Prophet) has treated you harshly. Anyhow, Allah does not make you live in a place where you feel inferior and your right is lost. So, join us, and we will console you.' When I read it, I said to myself, 'This is also a sort of test.' I took the letter to the oven and made a fire burning it. When forty out of the fifty nights elapsed, behold! There came to me a messenger of Allah's Messenger saying 'Allah's Messenger orders you to keep away from your wife.' I said, 'Should I divorce her; or else what should I do?' He said, 'No, only keep aloof from her and do not mingle with her.'

535 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (118 - 119) (Part-11) The Prophet jg sent the same message to my two fellows. I said to my wife, 'Go to your parents and remain with them until Allah gives His verdict in this matter.'" Ka*b added, "The wife of Hilal bin Umayyah came to Allah's Messenger ^ and said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Hilal bin Umayyah is a helpless old man who has no servant to attend on him. Do you dislike that I should serve him?' He said, v' jfi "No (you can serve him), but he should not come near you [sexuallyp.' She said, *By Allah! He has no desire for anything. By Allah, he has never ceased weeping since his case began until this day of his.' On that, some of my family members said to me, 'Will you also ask Allah's Messenger to permit your wife (to serve you) as he has permitted the wife of Hilal bin Umayyah to serve him?' I said, *By Allah, I will not ask permission of Allah's Messenger ^ regarding her, for I do not know what Allah's Messenger jg would say if I asked him to permit her (to serve me) while I am a young man.' We remained in that state for ten more nights, until the period of fifty nights was completed, starting from the time when Allah's Messenger jg prohibited the people from talking to us. When I had finished the Fajr prayer on the fiftieth morning on the roof of one of our houses, while sitting in the condition in which Allah described (in the Qur'an): my veiy soul seemed straitened to me and even the earth seemed narrow to me for all its spaciousness. There I heard the

voice of a man who had ascended the mountain of Sal' calling with his loudest voice, 'O Kah bin Malik! Be happy (by receiving good tidings).' I fell down in prostration before Allah, realizing that relief has come with His forgiveness for us. Allah's Messenger jg announced the acceptance of our repentance by Allah after Fajr prayer. The people went out to congratulate us. Some bearers of good news went to my two companions, a horseman came to me in haste, while a man from Banu Aslam came running and ascended the mountain and his voice was swifter than the horse. When the man whose voice I had heard, came to me conveying the good news, I took off my garments and dressed him with them; and by Allah, I owned no other than them on that day. Then I borrowed two

-A >*.1 it iSis; c. ^ iSd tSj £& > S Si i>p^ Cje % di % & u KE ^ ot tjs 4iljS^Jt£ t>Js it ijiSt ip; \$s ;jL4i'
 4Allah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhdjirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress, after the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated, but He accepted their repentance. Certainly, He is unto them full of kindness, Most Merciful. And the three who stayed behind, until for them the earth, vast as it is, was straitened and their souls were straitened to them, and they perceived that there is no fleeing from Allah, and no refuge but with Him. Then, He forgave them, that they might beg for His pardon. Verily, Allah is the Otte Who forgives and accepts repentance, Most Merciful. O you who believe! Have Taqzvd of Allah, and be with those who are true (in words and deeds).} Ka'b said; "By Allah! Allah has never bestowed upon me, apart from His guiding me to Islam, a greater blessing than the fact that I did not tell a lie to Allah's Messenger jg which would have caused me to perish, just as those who had told a lie have perished. Allah described those who told lies with the worst descriptions He ever attributed to anyone. Allah said, ijr^i frl fi* (•£* oy)n~*} <£-3 5>£ iffLAJZi '£t- C* £* Ufo if y 2*i pr iThey will swear by Allah to you when you return to than, that you may turn aioay from them. So turn away from them. Surely, they are Rijs (impure), and Hell is their dwelling place - a recompense for that which they used to earn . They swear to you that you may be pleased with them, but if you are pleased with than, certainly Allah is not pleased with the people who are rebellious.} Ka'b added, "We, the three persons, differed altogether from those whose excuses Allah's Messenger sg accepted when they swore to him. He took their pledge and asked Allah to forgive them, but Allah's Messenger left our case pending until Allah

538 Tafsfr Ibtt Kathir gave us Hisjudgement about it. As for that Allah said, «!#. m£> iAnd (He didforgive also) the three who stayed behind...}

What Allah said does not discuss our failure to take part in the battle, but to the deferment of making a decision by the Prophet about our case, in contrast to the case of those who had taken an oath before him, and he excused them by accepting their excuses." This is an authentic Hadith collected in the Two Sahlhs (Al- Bukhari and Muslim) and as such, its authenticity is agreed upon.*2 ' This Hadith contains the explanation of this honorable Ayah in the best, most comprehensive way. Similar explanation was given by several among the Salaf. For instance, Al-A'mash narrated from Abu Sufyan, from Jabir bin 'Abdullah about Allah's statement, ityr iAnd (He didforgive also) the three who stayed behind...} "They are Ka'b bin Malik, Hilal bin Umayyah and Murarah bin Ar-Rabl', all of them from the Ansar."*3 The Order to speak the Truth Allah sent His relief from the distress and grief that struck these three men, because Muslims ignored them for fifty days and nights, until they themselves, and the earth - vast as it is - were straitened for them. As vast as the earth is, its ways and paths were closed for them, and they

did not know what action to take. They were patient for Allah's sake and awaited humbly for His decree. They remained firm, until Allah sent His relief to them since they told the Messenger of Allah the truth about why they remained behind, declaring that they did not have an excuse for doing so. They were requited for this period, then Allah forgave them. Therefore, the consequence of being truthful was better for them, for they gained forgiveness. Hence Allah's statement next, *x * Ahmad 3:456. * Fath Al-Bari 8 :193 and Muslim 4 :2121 131 At-Tabaii 14:544.

<0 you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah, and be with those who are true The Ayah says, adhere to and always say the truth so that you become among its people and be saved from destruction. Allah will make a way for you out of your concerns and a refuge. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah said, JI>; Vj tf4JI JI 'J\ b\j i'J\ J^ JaJI j[i i Lflj luj 4)1 JL 'J* ^ JI «— Jijj ijilii Ji (s^h ol> J! iS^a LL IJLS^ 4)1 JIp IJI^j • JJ «HoW on to truth, for being truthful leads to righteousness, and righteousness leads to Paradise. Verily, a man will keep saying the truth and striving for truth, until he is written before Allah as very truthful (Siddiq). Beware of lying, for lying leads to sin, and sin leads to the Fire. Verily, the man will keep lying and striving for falsehood until he is written before Allah as a great liar .a' This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahibs.*2' s Z&&& te-O & 4 %4^%bi 1 44£ 4220. It was neither befitting for the people of Al-Madinah and the bedouins of the neighborhood to remain behind Allah's Messenger nor to prefer their own lives to his life. That is because they suffer neither Zama' nor Nasab, nor Makhmasah in the cause of Allah, nor did they take any step to raise the anger of disbelievers nor inflict any injury upon an enemy, but **' Ahmad 1 :384. ' FathAl-Bari 1 :523 and Muslim 4:2012.

541 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (120 - 121) (Part-11 his (righteous) deeds in the most perfect manner to be lost v;^ Sj2 Sf> 4 [yV^s» U i&i 4121 . Neither do they spend any contribution - small or great - nor cross a valley, but is written to their credit that Allah may recompense them with the best of what they used to do.) Allah said next, iNeithr do they spend}, in reference to the fighters in Allah's cause, 41i^=* Vj Ijki- ua} iany contribution - small or great -}, with regards to its amount, 4^i'j inor cross a valley}, while marching towards the enemy, ip^ ibut is written to their credit}, for these actions that they take [and which are under their control], ithat Allah may recompense them with the best of what they used to do.) Certainly, the Leader of the faithful, TJthman bin 'Aflan, may Allah be pleased with him, acquired a tremendous share of the virtues mentioned in this honorable Ayah. He spent large amounts and tremendous wealth on this battle (Tabak). Abdullah, the son of Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Khabb&b As-Sulami said; "The Messenger of Allah gave a speech in which he encouraged spending on the army of distress (for Tabuk). TJthman bin 'Affan, may Allah be pleased with him said; T will give one hundred camels with their saddles and supplies.' Then he jg exhorted them some more. So TJthman said; 1 will give one hundred more camels with their saddles and supplies.' Then he ^ descended one step of the Minbar and exhorted

Allah the Exalted here explains His order to Muslims to march forth with the Messenger of Allah sg for the battle of Tabuk. We should first mention that a group of the Salaf said that marching along with the Messenger jg, when he went to battle, was at first obliged on all Muslims, because, as they say, Allah said, 4'^—: •i) iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy> [9:41], and, 4It was not becoming of the people of Al-Madinah and the bedouins of the neighborhood...} [9:120]. However, they said, Allah

abrogated this ruling (9:41 and 9:120) when He revealed this Ayah, [9:122]. However, we could say that this Ayah explains Allah's order to participate in battle on all Arab neighborhoods, that at least a group of every tribe should march for Jihad. Those who went with the Messenger sg would gain instructions and studies in the revelation that came down to him, and warn their people about that battle when they returned to them. This way, the group that went with the Prophet jg will achieve both goals [Jihad and learning the revelation from the Prophet jg]. After the Prophet 5g, a group of every tribe or neighborhood should seek religious knowledge or perform Jihad, for in this case, Jihad is required from at least a part of each Muslim community. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas about the Ayah, 4Arid it is not (proper) for the believers to go out (to fight - Jihad) all together.} "The believers should not all go to battle and leave the Prophet  g alone, 40/every troop of them, a party only should go forth in the expeditions that the Prophet sg sent. When these armies returned to the Prophet, jg who in the meantime received

544 Tafstr Ibn Kathir revealed parts of the Qur'an from Allah, the group who remained with the Prophet sg would have learned that revelation from him. They would say, 'Allah has revealed some parts of the Qur'an to your Prophet and we learned it.' So they learned from them what Allah revealed to His Prophet jg in their absence, while the Prophet sg sent some other men into military expeditions. Hence Allah's statement, ithat they may get instructions in religion,} so that they learn what Allah has revealed to their Prophet sg and teach the armies when they return, 4so that they may beware.} 1 ^ Mujahid said, "This Ayah was revealed about some of the Companions of the Prophet jg who went to the desert and were helped by its residents, had a good rainy year and called whomever they met to guidance. The people said to them, *We see that you left your companions and came to us.' They felt bad in themselves because of this and they all came back from the desert to the Prophet jg. Allah said, & ot 'J 40/every troop of them, a party only should goforth,} those who seek righteousness [such as to spread the call of Islam, while others remain behind], ithat they may get instructions in (Islamic) religion,} and learn what Allah has revealed, 4and that they may warn their people}, when those who went forth returned to them, , u iso that they may beware (ofevil).}"[2] At-Tabari 14:565. 121 At-Tabari 14:566.

Qatadah said about this Ayah, "It is about when the Messenger of Allah jg sent an army; Allah commanded them to go into battle, while another group remained with the Messenger of Allah sg to gain instructions in the religion. Another group returns to its own people to call them (to Allah) and warn them against Allah's punishment of those who were before them." It was also said that this verse, ^ Kb 4And it is not (proper) for the believers to go out all together.} is not about joining Jihad. They say that the Messenger of Allah invoked Allah against Mudar to try them with years of famine, and their lands were struck by famine. The various tribes among them started to come, entire tribes at a time, to Al-Madlnah, because of the hardship they faced and they would falsely claim that they are Muslims. This caused hardship for the Companions of the Messenger jg and Allah revealed to him that they are not believers. The Messenger of Allah jg sent them back to their tribes and warned their people not to repeat what they did. Hence Allah's statement, 1^ '\$> tJj T •V iSSSP 'Wi soJJbAjj'j 4 cJj' l* o^j 111 At-Tabari 14:568.

and that they may warn their people when they return to them,} 3 5^5m fa. jiLJf y> 4123. O you who believe! Fight those of the disbelievers who are close to you, and let them find harshness in you; and

know that Allah is with those who have Taqwa.} The Order for Jihad against the Disbelievers, the Closest, then the Farthest Areas Allah commands the believers to fight the disbelievers, the closest in area to the Islamic state, then the farthest. This is

why the Messenger of Allah started fighting the idolaters in the Arabian Peninsula. When he finished with them and Allah gave him control over Makkah, Al-Madīnah, At-Ta'if, Yemen, Yamamah, Hajar, Khaybar, Hadramawt and other Arab provinces, and the various Arab tribes entered Islam in large crowds, he then started fighting the People of the Scriptures. He began preparations to fight the Romans who were the closest in area to the Arabian Peninsula, and as such, had the most right to be called to Islam, especially since they were from the People of the Scriptures. The Prophet ﷺ marched until he reached Tabuk and went back because of the extreme hardship, little rain and little supplies. This battle occurred on the ninth year after his Hijrah. In the tenth year, the Messenger of Allah was busy with the Farewell Hajj. The Messenger died eighty-one days after he returned from that Hajj, Allah chose him for what He had prepared for him [in Paradise]. After his death, his executor, friend, and Khalifah, Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, became the leader. At that time, the religion came under attack and would have been defeated, if it had not been for the fact that Allah gave the religion firmness through Abu Bakr, who established its basis and made its foundations firm. He brought those who strayed from the religion back to it, and made those who reverted from Islam return. He took the Zakah from the evil people who did not want to pay it, and explained the truth to those who were unaware of it. On behalf of the

547 Surah 9. At-Tawbah (123) (Part-11) Prophet ﷺ, Abu Bakr delivered what he was entrusted with. Then, he started preparing the Islamic armies to fight the Roman cross worshippers, and the Persian fire worshippers. By the blessing of his mission, Allah opened the lands for him and brought down Caesar and Kisra and those who obeyed them among the servants. Abu Bakr spent their treasures in the cause of Allah, just as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ had foretold would happen. This mission continued after Abu Bakr at the hands of the one whom Abu Bakr chose to be his successor, Al-Farooq, the Martyr of the Mihrab} 1 ^ Abu Hafs, Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him. With Umar, Allah humiliated the disbelievers, suppressed the tyrants and hypocrites, and opened the eastern and western parts of the world. The treasures of various countries were brought to Umar from near and far provinces, and he divided them according to the legitimate and accepted method. Umar then died as a martyr after he lived a praise worthy life. Then, the Companions among the Muhajirin and Ansar agreed to choose after Umar, Uthman bin Affan, Leader of the faithful and Martyr of the House, may Allah be pleased with him. During Uthman's reign, Islam wore its widest garment and Allah's unequivocal proof was established in various parts of the world over the necks of the servants. Islam appeared in the eastern and western parts of the world and Allah's Word was elevated and His religion apparent. The pure religion reached its deepest aims against Allah's enemies, and whenever Muslims overcame an Ummah, they moved to the next one, and then the next one, crushing the tyrannical evil doers. They did this in reverence to Allah's statement, «#Jf IAS '<\$ #£> 40 you who believe! Fight those of the disbelievers who are close to you,} Allah said next, I 1 ' Place of worship, where a Zoroastrian disbeliever assassinated Umar while he was leading the Muslims in prayer.

548 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4and let them find harshness in you}, meaning, let the disbelievers find harshness in you against them in battle. The complete believer is he who is kind to his believing brother, and harsh with his disbelieving enemy. Allah said in other Ayah, j&r&U \$H & ik&&32\$ iAllah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him; humble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers . . ^[5:54], iMuhammad is the Messenger of Allah . And those who are with him are severe against the disbelievers, and merciful among themselves .}[48:29], and, 40 Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be harsh against them.}\9:73\ Allah said, 4And know that Allah is with those who have Taqwd}, meaning, fight the disbelievers and trust in Allah knowing that Allah is with you if you fear and obey Him. This was the case in the first three blessed generations of Islam, the best members of this Ummah. Since they were firm on the religion and reached an unsurpassed level of obedience to Allah, they consistently prevailed over their enemies. During that era, victories were abundant, and enemies were ever more in a state of utter loss and degradation. However, after the turmoil began, desires and divisions became prevalent between various Muslim kings, the enemies were eager to attack the outposts of Islam and marched into its territory without much opposition. Then, the Muslim kings were too busy with their enmity for each other. The disbelievers then marched to the capital cities of the Islamic states, after gaining control over many of its areas, in addition to entire Islamic lands. Verily, ownership of all affairs is with Allah in the beginning and in the end. Whenever a just

Muslim king stood up and obeyed Allah's orders, all the while trusting in Allah, Allah helped him regain control over some Muslim lands and took back from the enemy what was compatible to his obedience and support to Allah. We ask Allah to help the Muslims gain control over the forelocks of His disbeliever enemies and to raise high the word of Muslims over all lands. Verily, Allah is Most Generous, Most Giving. ip\ : /Jl uti £ui[JjiS Vyt• t* tyj} ^ 4 Qj \$***2 % 4124. And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say: "Which of you has had his faith increased by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. 4125. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add Rijs (doubt) to their Rijs (doubt); and they die while they are disbelievers.} Faith of the Believers increases, while Hypocrites increase in Doubts and Suspicion Allah said, 4 <4K t 4And whenever there comes down a Surah}, then among the hypocrites are, 4some who say "Which of you has had his faith increased by it?" } They say to each other, who among you had his faith increased by this Surah [from the Qur'an]? Allah the Exalted said, 4&ZZ% !P' <<\$ tl} 4As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice.} This Ayah is one of the mightiest evidences that faith

550 Tafsir Ibn Kathir increases and decreases, as is the belief of most of the Salaf and later generations of scholars and Imams. Many scholars said that there is a consensus on this ruling. We explained this subject in detail in the beginning of the explanation of Sahih Al-Bukhari, may Allah grant him His mercy. Allah said next, iBut as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add Rijs to their Rijs the Surah increases them in doubt, and brings more suspicion on top of the doubts and suspicion that they had before. Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd We send down in the Qur'an that which is a healing^[17:82], and, j-0* Jij% '4 v oii'j A C iSay: "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it (the Qur'an) is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away (so they neither listen nor

understand)".^{41:44}] This indicates the misery of the hypocrites and disbelievers, since, what should bring guidance to their hearts is instead a cause of misguidance and destruction for them. Similarly, those who get upset by a type of food, for instance, will be upset and anxious even more if they are fed that food! ^{^ V } ^ } ^ 4^ JL\$& uj** d! lw- t* bjj TJ@s'ojfU! V (a* jnstj pr> -ml 4126 . See they not that they are put in trial once or twice every year? Yet, they turn not in repentance, nor do they learn a lesson (from it).}}

4.127. And whenever there comes down a Surah, they look at one another (saying): "Does any one see you?" Then they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts because they are a people that understand not.} Hypocrites suffer Afflictions Allah says, do not these hypocrites see. it that they are put in trial}, being tested, ^{4^1; fi% V Y^ jJ& 4}once or twice every year? Yet, they turn not in repentance, nor do they learn a lesson.} They neither repent from their previous sins nor learn a lesson for the future. Mujahid said that hypocrites are tested with drought and hunger. Allah said; ^{pp ^5 J] P* uA ^ ^p} ii •}% ft 'g. 4}And whenever there comes down a Surah, they look at one another (saying) : "Does any one see you?" Then they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts because they are a people that understand not.} This describes the hypocrites that when a Surah is revealed to the Messenger of Allah ^{5^5, 4uj“ & P&b 4}they look at one another}, they turn their heads, right and left, saying, ⁴"Does any one see you?" Then they turn away...} turning away from, and shunning the truth. This is the description of hypocrites in this life, for they do not remain m At-Tabari 14:580.

552 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir where the truth is being declared, neither accepting nor understanding it, just as Allah said in other Ayat, ^{vs-* Ji i}Then what is wrong with them that they turn away from admonition? As if they were ivild donkeys. Fleeing from a lion>[74:49-51], and, ^{^ 4^)^ 'fJ o* r" iMki OfJl J Li i}So what is the matter with those who disbelieve that they hasten to hear from you . (Sitting) in groups on the right and on the Ieft.}[70:36-37], This Ayah also means, what is the matter with these people who turn away from you to the right and to the left, to escape from truth and revert to falsehood? Allah's statement, ^{JL f * -v" * S>\ 4Hi i}Then they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts (from Truthfy is similar to, iSo when they turned away, Allah turned their hearts awau.} [61:5]. Allah said next, ^{A + •' i */ v oj*** V p> erVf i}because they are a people that understand not.} They neither understand Allah's Word nor attempt to comprehend it nor want it. Rather, they are too busy, turning away from it. This is why they ended up in this condition. ^{*nA ?& y *4 * *' < :Af if w yj 4228.} Verily, there Ims come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is eagerfor you ; for the believers [he is] full ofpity, kind, and merciful .}

\$129. But if they turn away, say: "Allah is sufficient for me. There is no God but He, in Him I put my trust and He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne."} The Advent of the Prophet jg is a Great Bounty from Allah Allah reminds the believers that He has sent to them a Messenger from among themselves, from their kind, speaking their language. Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said, ^{40ur Lord! Send among them a Messenger of their own.}} [2: 129] Allah said, ^{(ipj i] O* ' & } i}indeed, Allah conferred a greatfavor on the believers when He sent among them a Messengerfrom among themselves.}[3: 164] Allah said here, ^{fo jj& } 4}Verily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves.} meaning, from among you, speaking your language. Ja'far bin Abu Talib said to An-Najashi (the king of Ethiopia), and Al-Mughlrah bin Shu'bah said to the emissary of Kisra, "Allah has sent to us a Messenger from among us,

whose family lineage, description, early days, truth and honesty we know.” Allah said, “Whatever would cause hardship to his Ummah or be difficult for them, then it grieves him. Similarly, there is the Hadith reported through many routes that the Prophet said, ‘I was sent with the easy Hanifiyyah [monotheism] way.’” (Ahmad 1:202 and 5:291 * Ahmad 5:266. This is a weak narration, but there are supporting witnesses for it)

An authentic Hadith mentions, ‘Verily, this religion is easy’ and its Law is all easy, lenient and perfect. It is easy for those whom Allah the Exalted makes it easy, (He is eager for you), that you gain guidance and acquire benefits in this life and the Hereafter. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud said that the Messenger of Allah said, ‘I have been sent with the easy religion; every matter that Allah has prohibited, He knows that some among you will breach it; but I am indeed holding you by the waist so that you do not fall in the Fire, just like butterflies and flies. Allah’s statement next, if for the believers (he is) full of pity, kind, and merciful.) [9:128], is similar to His other statement, ‘And be kind and humble to the believers who follow you. Then if they disobey you, say: “I am innocent of what you do.” And put your trust in the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful) [26:215- Allah the Exalted commanded His Messenger in this honorable Ayah, ‘But if they turn away), from the glorious, pure, perfect and encompassing Law that you - O Muhammad - brought them, (Fath Al-Bari 1:116. •2| Ahmad 1:390.

Then say: “Allah is sufficient for me. There is no God but He, Allah is sufficient for me, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, and in Him I put my trust. Similarly, Allah said, ‘(He alone is) the Lord of the east and the west; there is no God but He. So take Him alone as a guardian.’ (73:9). Allah said next, ‘And He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne’ [9:129]. He is the King and Creator of all things, and He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne (‘Arsh), which is above all creation; all that is in and between the heavens and earths is under the Throne (‘Arsh) and subservient to Allah’s power. His knowledge encompasses all things, and His decision will certainly come to pass over all matters. He is the guardian of all things. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that Ubayy bin Ka’b said, “The last Ayah revealed from the Qur’an was this Ayah, ‘And He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne’ [9:128]” until the end of the Surah. It is recorded in the Sahih that Zayd bin Thabit said, “I found the last Ayah in Surah Bara’ah with Khuzaymah bin Thabit.” This is the end of Surah Bara’ah, all praise is due to Allah. (Ahmad 5:117. I2 ' Fath Al-Bari 8:195. Zayd bin Thabit, by the order of ‘Uthman bin ‘Allan, the Righteous Khalifah, compiled the Qur’an in one book from various manuscripts and from the Companions who memorized all or part of it.

Surah 10: Yunus

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2427]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Yunus (Chapter - 10)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2427–2433]

sg» P^ In the Name of Allah, the Most Beneficent, the Most Merciful 33E t.a iSSsaieT^ till-*>-0> iJajvj-jJitij o' c4%Z j#!£ Upp'^\ ppp-ppppppp/ppp&yp^ lAp/P\pLC opAjP ,_i£ji i4C ii; ^3i\$> 3 l££ os^ afrf 0\$*gH J J'v 3 £X j& J-Ult oj^3l jvi ji^TJ -Xlj j-Lrf> |>jj 4-. r,<v 'x* oi 41. Alif-Ldm-Rd. These are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an) Al- Hakim.} 42 . /s if a wonder for mankind that We have sent Our revelation to a man from among them- selves (saying) : “Warn mankind, and give good news to those who be- lieve that they shall have with their Lord the re- wards of their good deeds?” (But) the disbelievers say: "This is in- deed an evident sorcerer!"} The isolated letters in the beginning of this Surah, as well as in others, have been previously discussed at the beginning of

558 Talsir Ibn Kathir Surat Al-Baqarah. Allah said: i+gs i(cir. iThese are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an) Al-Hakim .} This indicates that these are verses of the Qur'an, in which the wisdom of judgment is clear. The Messenger cannot be but a Human Being Allah rebukes the attitude of the disbelievers with the words tf\} ils it a wonder for mankind. .^ [1 They have always found it strange that Allah would send Messengers to them from among mankind. Allah also tells us about other people from previous nations who said, iShall mere men guide us?} (64:6) HQd and Salih*2 ' said to their people: i&i \$>£ a%fc J » iDo you wonder that there has come to you a reminder from your Lord through a man from among you.} (7:63) Allah also told us what the disbelievers from Quraysh said: iHas he made the gods into one God? Verily, this is a curious thing!} (38:5) Ad-Dahhak reported Ibn 'Abbas that he said: “When Allah sent Muhammad^ as a Messenger, most of the Arabs denied him and his message and said: Allah is greater than sending a human Messenger like Muhammad.” Ibn 'Abbas said, “So Allah revealed: 111 At-Tabari 15:13. * Note : In Ayah 7 :63 this statement is made by Nut (not Salih , as erroneously mentioned by Ibn Kathir), and Had said the same to his people, in Ayah 7 :69.)

559 Surah 10. Yunus (2 - 3) (Part-11) ils it a wonder for mankind . Allah's statement; ithat they shall have with their Lord the rewards of their good deeds} Scholars have differed over the meaning of the reward for the good deeds in this Ayah: i* f2 a \p: £j} iand give good news to those who believe that they shall have with their Lord the rewards of their good deeds.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about this Ayah, “Eternal happiness has been written for them.”121 Al- 'Awfi reported that

Ibn ‘Abbas said: “It is the good reward for what they have done.” Mujahid said: “It is their good deeds - their prayers, fasting, charity, and glorification.” He then said, “And Muhammad %% will intercede for them.”¹³¹ Allah said: i(But) the disbelievers say: "This is indeed an evident sorcerer!" } This means that the disbelievers said this although Allah has sent a Messenger from among themselves to them, a mein of their own race as a bearer of good news and as a wamer. But they are the liars in saying that. £ >vt 32 £#3 } y jM&&& gfa oi i3. "Surely your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days and then rose over (Istawd) the Throne, arranging the affair [of all things]. No intercessor (can plead with Him) except after He permits. That is Allah, your Lord; At-Tabari 15:13. At-Tabari 15:15. At-Tabari 15:14.

so worship Him (alone). Then, will you not remember?} Allah is the Creator Who arranges the Affairs of the Universe Allah tells us that He is the Lord of the entire existence. He tells us that He created the heavens and the earth in six days. It was said: “Like these days (meaning our worldly days).” It was also said: “Every day is like a thousand years of what we reckon.” Later, this will be discussed further. iand then rose over (Istawa) the Throne.}” The Throne is the greatest of the creatures and is like a ceiling for them. Allah’s statement: 4arranging the affair [of all things], means that He controls the affairs ofthe creatures. * \ 4 }j> ; > 4Not even the weight of a speck of dust escapes His Knowledge in the heavens or in the earth .} (34:3) No affair distract’ Him from other affairs. No matter troubles Him. The persistent requests of His creatures do not annoy Him. He governs big things as He governs small things everywhere, on the mountains, in the oceans, in populated areas, or in wastelands. U *>'£ jf}i\ 4 ^ Cj} 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is duefrom Allah.} (11:6) 4% % /Hi 4 %«n «£2 4Not a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} (6:59)

Ad-Darawardi narrated from Sa’d bin Ishaq bin Ka’b bin ‘Ujrah that he said: “When this Ayah was revealed, iSurely, your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and tire earth^ they met a great caravan whom they thought should be Arabs. They said to them: Who are you?’ They replied: We are Jinns. We left Al-Madlnah because of this Ayah This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Allah said: 3. Jt Clt^ 4No intercessor (can plead with Him) except after He permits.} This is similar to what is in the following Ayah / r * # 1/ y\ iWho is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} (2:255) and, •SEj Jll ill oifc jwm o; pr iAnd there are many angels in tire heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.>(53:26), and; it£4& 4[Z* lllllf£ %} intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits.^(34:23). Allah then said: iThat is Allah, your Lord; so worship Him (alone). Then, will you not remember?} meaning worship Him alone with no partners. iThen will you not remember?} meaning “O idolators, you

meaning, the reward will be with justice and complete recompense. 4^j>& !\$? ii, SJ l&j 4Bwf those who disbelieved will have a drink of boiling fluids and painful torment because they used to disbelieve.} meaning, because of their disbelief they will be punished on

the Day of Resurrection by different forms of torment, such as

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fierce hot winds, boiling water, and the shadow of black smoke. 477n's is so/ Then let them taste it; a boiling fluid and dirty wound discharges. And other (torments) of similar kind all together!} (38:57-58) Jly'» 'rt'. jllAi 477i/s is the Hell which the criminals denied. They will go between it (Hell) and the fierce boiling water!} (55:43-44) /A *5%&£& 4a stt 45. It is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning. Allah did not create this but in truth. He explains the Ayat in detail for people who have knowledge.} 46. Verily, in the alternation of the night and the day and in all that Allah has created in the heavens and the earth are Ayat for those who have Taqwa.} Everything is a Witness to the Power of Allah. Allah tells us about the signs He created that are indicative of His complete power and great might. He made the rays that come forth from the bright sun as the source of light, and made the beams that come forth from the moon as light. He made them of two different natures so they would not be

confused with one another. Allah made the dominion of the sun in the daytime and the moon in the night. He ordained phases for the moon, where it starts small then its light increases until it completes a full moon. Then it begins to decrease until it returns to its first phase at the conclusion of the month. Allah said: J LI\$ Jll!> V 36 fyZ J&S iAnd the moon, We have measured for it mansions (to traverse) till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:39-40) And He said: iAnd the sun and the moon for counting And in this Ayah He said: iand measured} that is the moon, Allah said: iAtid measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning."} The days are revealed by the action of the sun, and the months and the years by the moon. Allah then stated i'j ill! jii. &} 4Allah did not create this but in truth.} He didn't create that for amusement but with great wisdom and perfect reasoning. With a similar meaning, Allah said: iAnd We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of

565 Surah 10. Yunus (5 - 6) (Part-11) those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire!} (38:27) He also said: 4"Did you think that We had created you in play (without any purpose), and that you would not be brought back to Us?" So Exalted be Allah, the True King: None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} [23:115-116] Allah said: iHe explains the Ayat in detail for people who have knowledge.} In other words, He explained the signs and proofs for people who know. Allah farther stated: * ** <* *9* < \ 'r^- 4^ iVerily, in the alternation of the night and the day} The day and the night alternate, when one arrives, the other goes, and so on, with no errors. This is similar to the meaning indicated in the following Ayat }He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly. ..}. 4'J3 AjX j\U *1} 4It is not for the sun to overtake the moon.} [36:40], and 4&Z J4' J3S 4(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting}. [6:96] Allah continued: ijfSAj vS 43

Js tism tm • >>^»f .1 •>/•>. l^-t>,'f"l^ • »**£ 3" •» > ?»? aujuj.l)I *•-> p4^' (jHjS'jJCa p-tj " «"f "l'tf? <<> "\T'y"- \ 's- <'>'.>>• O-gJ>iUjj >***—w*-r^C»t'^ ,^iVOVfc=»j-»»/w»4i6' Tafsir Ibtt Kathir *£&&!\$! ^ «« all that Allah has created in the heavens and the earth> meaning the signs that indicate His greatness. This is similar to Allah's statements: te&Xgoi s /< F &Jov yjll^ 4 ijJ. ,>; iAnd how many a sign in the heavens and the earth...» [12:105], J l>U *%&^ ^ u; ^4h>. ^ o6- <"Sfly: "Be/iofd a/1 that is in the heavens and the earth," but neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who believe not.}[10:101]

m \z#» iSee they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earthy [34:9]. «IMV(j;H \$. 4S& 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding.) [3:190] means intelligent men. Allah said here. iAydt for those who have Taqwa.) meaning fear Allah's punishment, wrath and torment.

U\$> Y i. 4^0jI?-5^ !£^=* >i*j^ ^7. Verily, those who hope not for their meeting with Us, but are pleased and satisfied with the life of the present world, and those who are heedless of Our Aydt,} {8. Those, their abode will be the Fire, because of what they used to earn.} The Abode of Those Who deny the Hour is Hell-Fire Allah describes the state of the wretched who disbelieved in the meeting with Allah on the Day of Resurrection and did not look forward to it, who were well-pleased with the life of this world and at rest in it. Al-Hasan said: "They adorned it and praised it until they were well pleased with it. Whereas they were heedless of Allah's signs in the universe, they did not contemplate them. They were also heedless of Allah's Laws, for they didn't abide by them. Their abode on the Day of Return is Fire, a reward for what they have earned in their worldly life from among their sins and crimes. That is beside their disbelief in Allah, His Messenger and the Last Day." <&&& A <9. Verily, those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, their Lord will guide them through their faith; under them will flow rivers in the Gardens of delight (Paradise.)} 410. Their way of request therein will be: "Glory to You, O Allah!" and "Salam" (peace, safety from evil) will be their greetings therein! And the close of their request will be: "All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} The Good Reward is for the People of Faith and Good Deeds In these two Ayat, Allah promises the happy blessings for those who believed in Allah and His Messengers. And for those

568 Tafstr Ibn Kathir that have complied with what they were commanded to follow. The promise is that He will guide them because of their faith, or it may mean through their faith. As to the first interpretation, the meaning is that Allah will guide them on

the Day of Resurrection to the straight path until they pass

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into Paradise because of their faith in this world. The other meaning is that their faith will assist them on the Day of Resurrection as Mujahid said: iTheir Lord will guide them through their faiths meaning "Their faith will be a light in which they will walk." 111 k ssM i >. I-**' iTheir way of request therein will be: "Glory to You, O Allah!" And Salam (peace, safety from evil) will be their greetings therein! And the close of their request will be: "All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists ") meaning this is the condition of the people of Paradise. This is similar to what is found in the following Ayat. iTheir greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be "Salam [Peace!]" [33:44], a. iu% %#£ SJX 'i) iNo Laghw (dirty, false, evil vain talk) will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: Salam! Salam!!") [56:25-26], i(It will be said to them): "Salam" - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful.) [36:58], CM At-Tabari 15:28.

4And angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you)!" 4 [13:23-24) In Allah's statement, 4And the close of their request will be: All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists." 4 There is an indication that Allah Almighty is the Praised One always,

the Worshipped at all times. This is why He praised Himself at the beginning and the duration of His creation. He also praised Himself in the beginning of His Book and the beginning of its revelation. Allah said: 4AU the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has sent down to His servant the Book (the Qur'an).> [18:1], oy1 - J ifjii aL ai Xl 4AU praise is due to Allah, Who (alone) created the heavens and the earth, [6:1], and many other citations with this meaning. The Ayah also indicates that Allah is the Praised One in this world and in the Hereafter and in all situations. In a Hadith recorded by Muslim: L US' iUjI Jjif jit "The people of Paradise will be inspired to glorify Allah and praise Him as they instinctively breath . [1 This will be their nature because of the increasing bounties of Allah upon them. These bounties are repeated and brought back again and increased with no limit or termination. So praise be to Allah for there is no God but He and no Lord save He. V o# j'E ^i lit & -at 4 m Muslim 4:2181

ill. And were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good then they would have been ruined. So We leave those who expect not their meeting with Us, in their trespasses, wandering blindly in distraction.} Allah does not respond to the Requests for Evil like He does with the Requests for Good Allah tells us about His Forbearance and Benevolence with His servants. He does not respond to them when they pray with evil intentions against themselves, their wealth or their children during times of grief or anger. He knows that they do not truly intend evil for themselves so He doesn't respond to them. This is in reality kindness and mercy. On the other hand. He responds to them when they pray for themselves, wealth and money, with good, blessing and growth. Allah has said, iAnd were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good then they would have been ruined.} This means that if He had responded to all of their evil requests, He would have destroyed them. However, people should avoid praying for evil as much as they can. Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded in his Musnad that Jabir said, "Allah's Messenger^ said: «Do not pray against yourselves, do not pray against your children, do not pray against your wealth, for your prayer may coincide with a time of response from Allah and Allah will respond to you. This Hadlth was also recorded by Abu Dawud.111 This is giinilflr to what is understood from the following Ayah: ij&i Abu Dawud 2 :185.

572Surah 10. Yunus (11 - 12) (Part-11 4And man invokes (Allah) for evil as he invokes (Allah) for good.>[17: 11] In regard to the interpretation of this Ayah, iAnd were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good> Mujahid said: "It is the man saying to his son or money when he is angry, 'O Allah don't bless him (or it) and curse him (or it).' Should Allah respond to this man in this request as He responds to him with good, He would destroy them." <&-^&& o*ra i jinif 4*®^^ C -4 Gil i 422. And when harm touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as ifhe had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him! Thus it is made foir seeming to the wasteful that which they used to do.} Man remembersAllah atTimes ofAdversityand forgets Him at Times ofProsperity Allah tells us about man and how he becomes annoyed and worried when he is touched with distress. icpfr&J jjj Jill ibut when evil touches him, then he has recourse to long supplications.^[41:51] "Long supplications' also means many supplications. Whenman suffers adversity he becomes worried and anxious. So he supplicates more. He prays to Allah to lift and remove the adversity. He prays while standing, sitting or laying

down. When Allah removes his adversity and lifts his distress, he turns away and becomes arrogant. He goes on as if nothing were wrong with him before. G1I £ m At-Tabari 15:34.

4He passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him!} Allah then criticized and condemned those who have these qualities or act this way, so He said: iThus it is made fair seeming to the wasteful that which they used to do.} But those on whom Allah has bestowed good guidance and support are an exception. iExcept those who have patience believe and do righteous good deeds.} [11:11]

The Prophet said: tty \ .3 iUi 3 Jii ^ V ^ji l/il^ yt a»-Si si> jJi) i«j yfz* op jr° oHow wonderful is the case of a believer ; there is good for him in everything and this is not the case with anyone except a believer. If prosperity attends him, he expresses gratitude to Allah, and that is good for him. And if adversity befalls him, he endures it patiently and that is also good for him.»in 413. And indeed, We destroyed generations before you when they did wrong, while their Messengers came to them with clear proofs, but they were not such as to believe! Thus do We requite the people who are criminals.} 414. Then We made you successors after them, generations after generations in the land, that We might see how you would toork.} Muslim 4 :2295

The Admonition held in the Destruction of the Previous Generations Allah tells us about what happened to past generations when they belied the Messengers and the clear signs and proofs the latter brought to them. Allah then made this nation successors after them. He sent to them a Messenger to test their obedience to Him and following His Messenger. Muslim recorded that Abu Nadrah reported from Abu Said that he said: “Allah’s Messenger said: \jS\i CaS j 1 jlJ to i'fj- UjjJt tl)Jo ^ oils Jji tJLUL \yu\j UljJl tThe world is indeed sweet and green; and verily Allah is going to install you generations after generations in it in order to see how you act. So safeguard yourselves against the world and avoid (the trial caused by) women. For the first trial of the Children of Israel was due to women.. »|11 Ibn Jarir reported from ‘Abdur-Rahman from Ibn Abi Layla that ‘Awf bin Malik said to Abu Bakr: “In a dream, I saw a rope hanging from the sky and Allah’s Messenger jg was being raised. The rope was suspended again and Abu Bakr was raised. Then people were given different measurements around the Minbar, and ‘Umar was favored with three forearm measurements.” Umar said: “Keep your dream away from us, we have no need for it.” When Umar succeeded, he called for ‘Awf and said to him, “Tell me about your dream?” ‘Awf said: “Do you need to hear about my dream now? Did you not scold me before?” He then said, “Woe unto you! I hated for you to announce it to the successor of Allah’s Messenger himself.” So ‘Awf related his dream until he got to the three forearms, he said: “One that he was Khalifah, second he did not - for the sake of Allah - fear the blame of blamers, and third he was a martyr.” Allah said: iJuT 2^4 iThen We made you successors after them, generations after generations in the land, that YJe might see how you would IH Muslim 4:2098

ji aS'^jTjdfc_ ^oC3\<z3 rfs f. > <ii*fc. i ^ •// i<*^ », «* ."? > ; < * V' '4 vl'-v .1' OjLJjCa3«^ajOj3' jjl ^=^Jb>ajuU -uil Ji^jtCj-^=>ailJfi'^JJj^c^i- ts&s&KP " . jf-' T'-i.-r. ioorJt.>(10:14) Then he said: “Son of the mother of TJmar, you have been appointed as Khalifah, so look at what you will do! About not fearing the blame of blamers, that is Allah’s will. About becoming a martyr, how can TJmar reach that when the Muslims are in support of him?” ^uo: £3 10 lira 'oyrs. * x m fel 3 4 £ 3 C % gi oi 2*2 ^BLj 41 wJ!. 2#y> »/ /><^ »/ > */" -£j» <->UC tJj C->.-ag t»i [»r-^ OjwJ jji j^Cyal 3* /-yti U ail its. ji Ji

dp^-r4»“ 415. And when Our clear Ayat are recited unto them, those who hope not for their meeting with Us, say: "Bring us a Qur'an other than this, or change it." Say: "It is not for me to change it on my own accord; I only follow that which is revealed unto me. Verily, I fear the torment of the Great Day (the Day of Resurrection) if I were to disobey my Lord."} 416. Say: "If Allah had so willed, I should not have recited it to you nor would He have made it known to you. Verily, I [i] Af-Tabari 15:39.

have stayed among you a lifetime before this. Have you then no sense?'ft Obstinace of the Chiefs of the Quraysh Allah tells us about the obstinace of the disbelievers of the Quraysh, who were opposed to the message and denied Allah. When the Messenger \$g read to them from the Book of Allah and His clear evidence they said to him: "Bring a Qur'an other than this." They wanted the Prophet jg to take back this Book and bring them another book of a different style or change it to a different form. So Allah said to His Prophet jg: 4Say : "It is not for me to change it on my own accordft This means that it is not up to me to do such a thing. I am but a servant who receives commands. I am a Messenger conveying from Allah. <jj c>l <-& Zfy. 6 oft 41 only follow that which is revealed unto me. Verily, I fear the torment of the Great Day (the Day of Resurrection) if I were to disobey my Lordft The Evidence of the Truthfulness of the Qur'an Muhammad sg\$ then argued with supporting evidence to the truthfulness of what he had brought them: 4Say: "If Allah had so willed, I should not have recited it to you nor would He have made it known to you ...'ft This indicates that he brought this only with the permission and will of Allah for him to do so. The proof of this was that he had not fabricated it himself and that they were incapable of refuting it, and that they should be fully aware of his truthfulness and honesty since he grew up among them, until Allah sent the Message to him. The Prophet was never criticized for anything or held in contempt. So he said.

576 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iVerily, I have stayed among you a lifetime before this. Have you then no sense?} Which meant "don't you have brains with which you may distinguish the truth from falsehood?" When Heraclius, the Roman king, asked Abu Sufyan and those who were in his company about the Prophet jg, he said: "Have you ever accused him of telling lies before his claim?" Abu Sufyan replied: "No." Abu Sufyan was then the head of the disbelievers and the leader of the idolators, but he still admitted the truth. This is a clear and irrefutable testimony since it came from the enemy. Heraclius then said: "I wondered how a person who does not tell a lie about others could ever tell a lie about Allah." Ja'far bin Abu Talib said to An-Najashi, the king of Ethiopia: "Allah has sent to us a Messenger that we know his truthfulness, ancestral lineage, and honesty. He stayed among us before the prophethood for forty years."*2 417. So who does more wrong than he who forges a lie against Allah or denies His Ayat? Surely, the criminals will never be successful'.} Allah says that no one is more wrong, unjust and arrogant than he who invented a lie against Allah, forged claims about Allah, or claimed that Allah has sent a message to him but his claim was not true. No one is more of a criminal or has committed greater wrong than such a person. Liars cannot be confused with Prophets. Anyone who claims such a thing, whether lying or telling the truth, will necessarily be supported by Allah with proofs and signs of his falsehood or truthfulness. The difference between Muhammad jg and Musaylamah the liar, was clearer to those who met both of them than the difference between forenoon and midnight when it is extremely dark. Those who are clear-sighted can distinguish via signs and proofs between the truthfulness of Muhammad sg and the 111 FathAl-B&ri8:82. 121 Ahmad 1 :202.

falsehood of Musaylamah the liar, Sajah and Al-Aswad Al-Ansi. Abdullah bin Salam said: "When Allah's Messenger ﷺ, arrived at Al-Madinah, people were scared away and I was one of them. But when I saw him, I realized that his face could never be the face of a liar. The first thing I heard from him was his statement: *jm *jL>j ijLsAj ijH\ i<ij u;*» <U>J1 «0 people, spread the greetings of peace, feed others, be dutiful to your relatives and offer prayers in the night when others are asleep so that you will enter Paradise in peace . »"[1 ' When Dimam bin Thalabah came to Allah's Messenger jg and asked him in the presence of his people - Banu Sa'd bin Bakr: "Who raised this heaven?" He replied, »Allah*). He asked: "And who erected these mountains?" He replied, «4jI» «AJ/a/i». He asked: "Who spread out this earth?" He replied, uAllahn. Then he asked: "I ask you in the name of the One, Who raised the heavens, erected the mountains, and spread out this earth, has Allah sent you as a Messenger to all mankind?" He said, *iBy Allah, Yes'J Then Dimam asked him about Salah, Zakah, Hajj and fasting. With every question he swore by Allah and with every response the Prophet swore also. Dimam then said: "You indeed are telling the truth. By the One Who sent you with the truth I will not increase or decrease from what you have told me." This man was content with the few responses of the Prophet jg. He was convinced of the Prophet's truthfulness by the signs that he saw and witnessed. It was narrated that 'Amr bin Al-'As went to Musaylamah. 'Amr was not a Muslim at that time and he was a friend of Musaylamah. Musaylamah said: "Woe unto you 'Amr. What was revealed unto your friend - meaning Allah's Messenger jg- during this period?" 'Amr replied: "I heard his companions 111 Ahmad 5:451. ' See Zad Al-Ma'ad 3:647, and its source is in Al-Bukhari no. 63, and Muslim no . 12 , and others

reading a short but great Surah." He asked, "And what was that?" He recited: 4By Al-'Asr (the time). Verily, man is in loss.} [103:1-2] until the end of the Surah. Musaylamah thought for a while and then said: "Something similar to that was also revealed to me." 'Amr asked: "And

what is it?" He then recited: "O Wabr, O Wabii You are only

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two ears and a breast. The rest of you is hollow.' What do you think, 'Amr?" 'Amr then said: "By Allah, you know that I know that you are a liar."111 This was a statement made by an idolator in judgment of Musaylamah. He knew Muhammad 3^5 and his truthfulness. He also knew Musaylamah and his tendency toward falsehood and lying. People who think and have insight know even better. Allah said: j/c jis di £4 pj (fd 4 1^2 4*&\$ z JL 4And who does more aggression and wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Ayat.) [6:21] 4So who does more wrong than he who Jorge a lie against Allah or denies His Ayat? Surely, the criminals will never be successful!} [10:17] No one is more unjust than he who belies the truth which the Messengers have brought supported with evidence and proof. J» jiil Y £\$ <ji dxf ot tfij ijfcZZ Vx^j sr CJ m Al-Biddiyah wan-Nihayah 6 :326 .

579Surah 10. Yunus (18 - 19) (Part-11) }18. And they worship besides Allah things that harm them not, nor profit them, and they say: "These are our intercessors with Allah." Say : "Do you inform Allah of that which He knows not in the heavens and on the earth?" Glorified and Exalted is He above all that which they associate as partners (with Him)!} 419. Mankind were but one community, then they

differed (later); and had not it been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, it would have been settled between them

regarding what they differed.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2449–2475]

What do the Idolators believe about Their Gods? Allah reproaches the idolators that worshipped others beside Allah, thinking that those gods would intercede for them before Allah. Allah states that these gods do not harm or benefit. They don't have any authority over anything, nor do they own anything. These gods can never do what the idolators had claimed about them. That is why Allah said: 4£ 4p v tL& & 4Say: 'Do you inform Allah of that which He knows not in the heavens and on the earth?' Ibn Jarir said: "This means, 'Are you telling Allah about what may not happen in the heavens and earth?'" Allah then announced that His Glorious Self is far above their Shirk and Kufr by saying: iGlorified and Exalted is He above all that which they associate as partners (with Him)!^ Shirk isNew Allah then tells us that Shirk was new among mankind. It was not in existence in the beginning. He tells us that people were believers in one religion and that religion was Islam. Ibn 'Abbas said: "There were ten centuries between Adam and m At-Tabari 15:46.

Noh. They were all on Islam. Then differences among people took place. They worshipped idols and rivals. So Allah sent extensive evidence and irrefutable proof with His Messengers." 1 ' /<»/ f + /./ / * / • \ iSo that those who were to be destroyed (for rejecting the faith) might be destroyed after a clear evidence, and those who were to live might live after a clear evidence.}[8:42] Allah's statement: 4^5« 'i&f iAnd had not it been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord...} means that if Allah had not decreed He would not punish anyone until the evidence is established against them. And also that if He had not given creatures a respite until a defined term had passed, He would have judged among them in what they disputed. Then He would have caused the believers to be happy and delighted and the disbelievers to be miserable and wretched. a C\ jii 4\$ oi k\:& 3^1% 'it 420. And they say: "How is it that not a sign is sent down on him from his Lord?" Say: "The Unseen belongs only to Allah, so wait you, verily, I am with you among those who wait."} The Idolators requested a Miracle These stubborn, lying disbelievers said, "Why would not a sign be revealed to Muhammad horn his Lord." They meant a sign such as given to Salih. Allah sent the she-camel to Thamud. They wanted Allah to change the mount of As-Safa into gold or remove the mountains of Makkah and replace them with gardens and rivers. Allah is capable of doing all of that, but He is All-Wise in His actions and statements. Allah l1 ' Al-Biddiyah wan-Nihayah 1 :101 , and he said, "Al-Bukhari recorded it."

581Surah 10. Yunus (20) (Part-11 said: i*ii Iji CK iSfa *4'* ij* «*fl (J-V- £>,(4A-f} li-tlel) icLliij j; ,- ;V . iBlessed be He Wlw, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that - Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise) and will assign you palaces (in Paradise) . Nay, they deny the Hour, and far those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire.}[25:10-11] He also said: ^ ' If? L *u iAtid nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people ofold denied them.} (17:59] Allah's way of dealing with His creatures is that He would give to them if they asked things from Him. But if they then didn't believe He would expedite punishment for them. When Allah's Messenger 0 was given the choice of Allah giving the people what they requested but if they didn't believe they would be

punished, or that their request would not be answered immediately, Allah's Messenger⁰ chose the latter. Allah guided His Prophet jg to answer their question by saying: iSay : "The Unseen belongs only to Allah..." } This Ayah means that the matter in its entirety is for Allah. He is well aware of the outcome of all matters. 4 "...so wait you, verily, I am with you among those who wait." } If you would not believe unless you witness that which you asked for, then wait for Allah's judgement for me, as well as for yourselves. Nonetheless, they had witnessed some of the signs and miracles of the Prophet ⁰, which were even greater than what they had asked for. In their presence, the Prophet⁰ pointed to the moon when it was full and it split into two parts.

583 Surah 10. Yunus (20 - 21) (Part-11) iimm TU SSS9SS ^ i/ £ K (^ 4* + JauJ Ijily ^>*^(*J' ^W-J /U/ O/oLaii&^IJu^od ^ its®-? obvious magic!')[6:7] Such people don't deserve to have their requests answered, for there is no benefit in answering them. These people are obstinate and stubborn as a result of their corruption and immorality. Therefore Allah told His Messenger jgj to say: oj 41 4So laaif you, verily, I am with you among tlwse who wait. } juo ^ ^uy Uii • ,C. •>;< ,A-* W p—• W Si 'it j» bcc r* SSS /3& /if 4 U^ <££ ->-\$-; J«? (*ri ijT ji £P''' (tiiirJ £>J ^ fr^ CVi 'ij Ui OJ i* ULiji jJ ,/jli li 05-^ «if ij£> i^i C% ii^if gsJM £ a j^f <34 £jf^ ^f 4 -i>r cl ,5242 422. And when We let mankind taste mercy after some adversity has afflicted them, behold! They take to plotting against Our Aydt! Say: "Allah is more swift in planning!" Certainly, Our messengers (angels) record all of that which you plot. } 422 . He it is Who enables you to travel through land and sea,

till when you are in the ships, and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they are glad therein, then comes a stormy wind and the waves come to them from all sides, and they think that they are encircled therein. Then they invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (alone), (saying) : "If You (Allah) deliver us from this, we shall truly, be of the grateful. i23. But when He delivers them, behold! They rebel (disobey Allah) in the earth wrongfully. O mankind! Your rebellion is only against yourselves, - a brief enjoyment of this worldly life, then (in the end) unto Us is your return, and We shall inform you of that which you used to do. Man changes when He receives Mercy after Times of Distress Allah tells us that when He makes men feel His mercy after being afflicted with distress, ~j iThey take to plotting against Our Aydt.\$ The coming of mercy after distress is like the coming of ease after hardship, fertility after aridity, and rain after drought. Mujahid said that man's attitude indicates a mockery and belying of blessings.^ ' The meaning here is similar to Allah's statement: ji *}—>! tilej J- iAnd when harm touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. 10:12) Al-Bukhari recorded that Allah's Messenger led the Subh (Dawn) prayer after it had rained during the night, then he jg said: JIS ISU b/jZ "Do you know what your Lord has said last night? They replied, "Allah and His Messenger know better." He jg said: m Aj>Tabari 15:49.

jill • JI* Ij UfotA I (Jl5 ^jA liti Sj ^ *j» x y ji £p»' : Jli® Lafj . . jTVSvJlj ^3IS «<__^_>sdu^^ ^IS illii IJSj «A//fl/i said; "This morning, some of My servants have become believers and some disbelievers in Me. He who said: We have had tltis rainfall due to the grace and mercy of Allah' is a believer in Me and a disbeliever in the stars. And he who said 'we have had this rainfall due to the rising of such and such star' is a disbeliever in Me and a believer in the stars.®111 The Ayah iSay : "Allah is more swift in planning!" } means that Allah is more capable of gradually seizing them with punishment, while granting them concession of a delay until the criminals think that they would not be punished. But in

reality they are in periods of respite, then they will be taken suddenly. The noble writers (meaning the angels who write the deeds) will write everything that they do and keep count of their deeds. Then they will present it before the All-Knowing of the seen and unseen worlds. The Lord will then reward them for the significant deeds and even the seemingly insignificant that may be as tiny as a spot on a date pit. Allah further states: 4/3'j 4He it is Who enables you to travel through land and sea...} which means that He preserves you and maintains you with His care and watching. iTill when you are in the ships, and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they are glad therein...} meaning smoothly and calmly; m Fath Al-Bari2 :607 .

586 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4then comes (these ships)} 4a stormy wind} iand the waves come to themfrom all sides,} i-^ti iand they think that they are encircled therein} meaning that are going to be destroyed. 4i\$ 2 S iTen they invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (alone)} meaning that in this situation they would not invoke an idol or statue besides Allah. They would single Him out alone for their supplications and prayers. This is similar to Allah's statement: se ± JS j# i jitp: fy} 4And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him (Allah alone). But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away (from Him). And man is ever ungrateful.} [17:67] And in this Surah, He says: 4*ti& ly, laulii 'j 2i(I£& iTen they invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (saying): "IfYou (Allah) deliver usfrom this (situation)."} 4"We shall truly, be of the grateful."} This means that we will not ascribe others as partners with You. We will later worship You alone as we are praying to You here and now. Allah states; 4fi#

587Surah 10. Yunus (21 - 23) (Part-11) 4But when He delivers them> from that distress, 4^ 4 Sfv. (U 4behold! They rebel (disobey Allah) in the earth wrongfully...} meaning: they returned as if they had never experienced any difficulties and had never promised Him anything. So Allah said: 4fe* p \$£=>} 4He passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched Wwi/^ (10:12] Allah then said: 4&&& ffeSqsM 40 mankind! Your rebellion (disobedience to Allah) is only against yourselves,} it is you yourselves that will taste the evil consequence of this transgression. You will not harm anyone else with it, as comes in the Hadith, 4)1 U CjJI ^ 4) I Jmj «— ^*® »77iere is no sin that is more worthy that Allah hasten punishment for in this world - on top of the punishment that Allah has in store for it in the Hereafter - than oppression and cutting the ties of the womb .»|11 Allah's statement: 4Q% &} 4a brief enjoyment of this worldly life...} means that you only have a short enjoyment in this low and abased worldly life. 4then (in the end) unto Us is your return...} meaning your goal and final destination. ll* Abu D&wud 5 :208.

iand We shall inform you of all your deeds. Then we shall recompense you for them. So let him who finds good (in his record) praise Allah, and let him who finds other than that blame no one but himself. ffl e* oG .4, sm u V* t# & qja <&> & p ^ ji & 4 S2 *^^ >4 i>i: 45 ^5tofcS£ 424. Verily, the parable of the life of the world is as the water which We send down from the sky; so by it arises the intermingled produce of the earth of which men and cattle eat until when the earth is clad in its adornments and is beautified, and its people think that they have all the powers of disposal over it, Our command reaches it by night or by day and We make it like a clean-mown harvest, as if it had not flourished yesterday! Thus do We explain the Ayat in detail for the people who reflect.} 425. Allah calls to the Abode of Peace (Paradise) and guides whom He wills to the straight path.} The Parable ofthis Life Allah the

Almighty has set an example of the similitude of the life of this world, its glitter and the swiftness of its passage, likening it to the plant and vegetation that Allah brings out from the earth. This plant grows from the water that comes down from the sky. These plants are food for people, such as fruits and other different types and kinds of foods. Some other kinds are food for cattle such as clover plants (i.e. green fodder for the cattle) and herbage etc. until when the earth is clad in its adornments, and is beautified meaning, it became good by what grows on its hills such as blooming flowers of different shapes and colors. i'W

and its people think... those who planted it and put it in the ground, and that they have all the powers of disposal over it to cultivate it and harvest it. But while they were in that frame of mind, a thunderbolt or a severe, cold storm came to it. It dried its leaves and spoiled its fruits. Allah said: 4^ (ft jt yd0 iOur command reaches it by night or by day and We make it like a clean-mown harvest it became dry after it was green and flourishing. O'* £2 \$ <*> 4as if it had not flourished yesterdayfy as if nothing existed there before. Qatadah said: "As if it had not flourished; as if it was never blessed." Such are things after they perish, they are as if they had never existed. Similarly, the Hadith, wfj J- : iJ Jlij jfbl ^ ^ 4 UjjJl^ Lljp xit aj ii, j (Jp w ojd jjJj ji : is jii; «A person who led the most prosperous life in this world loill be brought up and dipped once in the Fire. He will then be asked: 'Have you ever found any good or comfort?' He will reply: 'No.' And a person who had experienced extreme adversity in this world will be brought up and dipped once in the bliss (of Paradise). Then he will be asked: 'Did you ever face any hardship or misery?' He will reply : 'No.'s* 11 Allah said about those who were destroyed: 4So they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes; as if they had never lived there.^[1 1:67-68] *** Muslim 4:2162.

Allah then said: 91 J-il <77iws do We explain the Ayat...) We do explain the proofs, and evidences, in detail ifor the people who reflect.) so they may take a lesson from this example in the swift vanishing of this world from its people while they are deceived by it. They would trust this world and its promises, and then it unexpectedly turns away from them. This world, in its nature, runs away from those who seek it but seeks those who run away from it. Allah mentioned the parable of this world and the plants of the earth in several Ayat in His Noble Book. He said in Surat Al-Kahf. fvili ui'i' Jllit till)! & 4lT Gill Xyi5 fX CjjjAj) \$& ia' ajjil tLu iAnd putforward to them the example of the life of this world it is like the water (rain) which We send dawn from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter. And Allah is able to do everything.) (18:45) He also gave similar examples in both Surat Az-Zumar [39:21] and Surat Al-Hadid (57:20). Invitation to the Everlasting Gifts that do not vanish Allah said: /> dl 'y-j? '*))) 4And Allah calls to the Abode ofPeace) When Allah mentioned the swiftness of this world and its termination. He invited people to Paradise and encouraged them to seek it. He called it the Abode of Peace. It is the Abode of Peace because it is free from defects and miseries. So Allah said:

592Surah 10. Yunus (24 - 25) (Part-11) iAUah calls to the Home ofPeace and guides whom He wills to the straight path> It was narrated that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said: "Allah's Messenger sSgj came out one day and said to us: Jyu ^ •P: Jij** dfe flU^ oJij UJI ivlllli jip ijplj niljl liwl : Jlii tisU * 151s liJi ii^{ jij ii& p44j 1 4^y ^44* tjly^ ^4 JjjU-f ij^; iUi l; cJi; i*UJi 4dtj jilJi} tdJUJi Ji>u ,l<4 <UJ' J 1&J 1 jis fV^j' yj </ fame seen in my sleep that it was as if fibril was at my head and Mikd'il at my leg. They were saying to each other: 'Give an example for him.' He said: 'Listen, your ear may listen. And fathom, your

heart may fathom. The parable of you and your Ummah is that of a king who has built a house on his land. He arranged a banquet in it. Then he sent a messenger to invite the people to his food. Some accepted the invitation and others did not. Allah is the King and the land is Islam, the house is Paradise and you Muhammad are the Messenger. Whosoever responds to your call enters Islam. And whosoever enters Islam enters Paradise. And whosoever enters Paradise eats from it." Ibn Jarir recorded this Hadith. It was also reported that Abu Ad-Darda' said that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: ﷺ <u ^1>- ﷺ <jLsdu* Vj d oJilg •fijP Jt'j\$ tk "r&j J \ !>&» i# I *Two angels descend every day in which the sun rises and say that which all Allah's creatures would hear except Jinn and humans: 'O people! Come to your Lord! Anything little and sufficient is better than a lot but distractive And He sent this down in the Qur'an when He said: IM At-Jabari 15:61.

ijni£ Ji \£l%} i"Allah calls to the Abode of Peace".} Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this.' X> o&,) aJjA \l. <'! »i'. •>' >> -AJ &>. (U 4*^ 426. For those who have done good is the best, and even more. Neither darkness nor dust nor any humiliating disgrace shall cover their faces. They are the dwellers of Paradise, they will abide therein forever.} The Reward of the Good-Doers Allah states that by having faith and performing righteous deeds - will be rewarded with a good reward in the Hereafter. Allah said: vi^r '£4- fri ils there any reward for good other than good?}(55:60) Then Allah said: iand even more.} the reward on the good deeds multiplied ten times to seven hundred times and even more on top of that. This reward *** At-Tabari 15 :60, and Ahmad 5 : 197. those who do good in this world -

includes what Allah will give them in Paradise, such as the palaces, Al-Hur (virgins of Paradise), and His pleasure upon them. He will give them what He has hidden for them of the delight of the eye. He will grant them on top of all of that and even better, the honor of looking at His Noble Face. This is the increase that is greater than anything that had been given. They will not deserve that because of their deeds, but rather, they will receive it by the grace of Allah and His mercy. The explanation that this refers to looking at Allah's Noble Face was narrated from Abu Bakr, Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman, 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abu Layla, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Sabit, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Amir bin Sa'ad, 'Ata', Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As- Suddi, Muhammad bin Ishaq, and others from the earlier and later scholars. * There are many Hadiths that contain the same interpretation. Among these Hadiths is what Imam Ahmad recorded from Suhayb that Allah's Messenger recited this Ayah, {For those who have done good is the best and even more.} And then he said: x* fa l Jit U)&l jit) SiJl Jit jii lip j)Jl ?£jli) Jii jUi ?)* U) jt 13c. <3>1 i — Jli — ?jllll ^jA 11a 'J\ ij)d! j&\ vli-t <3>1 jUUait U <3>1)i <<J! 'o/ji'4 "When the people of Paradise enter Paradise, a caller will say: 'O people of Paradise, Allah has promised you something that He wishes to fulfill/ They will reply: "What is it? Has He not made our Scale heavy? Has He not made our faces white and delivered us from Fire?' Allah will then remove the veil and they will see Him . By Allah, they have not been given anything dearer to than and more delightful than looking at Him . HI At-Tabari 15:63-68.

595 Surah 10. Yunus (27) (Part-11) similar evil, without any increase iand will cover them} meaning that their faces will be covered and overtaken by humiliation because of their sins and their fear from these sins. Similarly Allah said: iAnd you will see them brought forward to it, (Hell) made humble by disgrace.^[42:45] He also said: /Ji fc-Z ili at up* 'M 4Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror. (They will

be) hastening forward with necks outstretched, their heads raised up (towards the sky).}[14:42 - 43] Allah then said: 4^d «\$ 4No defender will they havefrom Allah.} meaning, there will be no protectors to prevent them from punishment as Allah said: JI^xi> V d iek 40n that Day man will say: "Where (is the refuge) to flee?" No! There is no refuge! Unto your Lord (alone) will be the place ofrest that Day.}[75:10-12] Allah's statement: iTheirfaces will be covered as it were.. .} means that their faces will be dark in the Hereafter. This is similar to His statement: *> >- V ^ /V b*jj» j*> •>> x : -it rfc S>>-* <"(•' » fj JJ*' W» •yrJ J>~>J tyri fJir

596 Tafsir Ibri Kathir iOn the Day (the Day of Resurrection) when some faces will become white and some faces will become black; as for those whose faces will become black (to them will be said) : "Did you reject faith after accepting it? Then taste the torment (in Hell) for rejecting faith." And for those whose faces will become white, they will be in Allah's mercy (Paradise), therein they shall dwellforever>[3:106-107] He also said: (if • »>>- ^ vt-jj -t •»> 'V•j*-4 -fry. wr iSome faces that Day will be bright, laughing, rejoicing at good news (of Paradise) . And other faces that Day will be dust-stained.\$[80:38-40] ok\$ Y £ j&Cs £ (t 4 I'ijS&& pr tf iX £^& ^ k Ji G& c&J 12 J, \$ \% 42S. And the Day whereon We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who did set partners in worship with Us: "Stop at your place! You and your partners." Then We shall separate them, and their partners shall say: "It was not us that you used to worship."} 429. "So sufficient is Allah as a witness between us and you that we indeed knew nothing ofyour worship of us."} 430. There! Every person will know (exactly) what he had earned before and they will be brought back to Allah, their rightful Mawla (Lord), and their invented false deities will vanishfrom them.} The gods of the Idolaters will claim Innocence from them on the Day ofResurrection Allah said: iAnd the Day whereon We shall gather them Allah will gather together all the creatures of earth, human

597Surah 10. Yunus (28 - 30) (Part-U) and Jinn, righteous and rebellious. He said in another Ayah: We shall gather them all together so as to leave tiot one of them behind.>(18:47) X jSSfc i£i< ii.# *> 4^ien We s/w// say fo those who did associate partners: ",Stop at your place! You and your partners.") He then will command the idolators to stay where they are and not to move from their destined places so they would be separated from the place of the believers. Similarly, Allah said: 4(11 will be said): "And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day (from the believers.).){36:59) Allah also said: 4 fry. fjk '(yfi) 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated (the believers will be separatedfrom the disbelievers.).)[30: 14] In the same Surah, [Ar-Rtim], Allah said: /' - J- . V fry? 40n that Day men shall be divided.) [30:43] means, they shall be divided in two. This is what will take place when Allah Almighty will come for Final Judgement. The believers intercede to Allah so the Final Judgement may come and they get rid of that state. The Prophet sg said, s , , , . ^'jS fjS (jJ J "Oh the Day of Resurrection, we will be in a visible place above the [other] people.^ Allah tells us here what He is going to command the idolators and their idols to do on the Day of Resurrection (J| Ahmad 3 :346.

599Surah 10. Yunus (30 - 31) (Part-11) both good and evil. Similarly, Allah said: il&Z*30 4The Day when all the secrets will be examined.}[86:9], fj* ^ iOn that Day man will be informed ofwhat he sentforward (of deeds), and what he left behind.^[75:13], and 4;;J^&\$ \jJl» ii; £ %&> 4...and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring outfor him a book which he will find wide open. (It will be said to

him): "Read your book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day") (17:13-14] Then Allah said, and they will be brought back to Allah, their rightful Mawla.) AH affairs and matters will be brought back to Allah, the Judge, the All-Just. He will judge everyone, and then admit the people of Paradise in Paradise and the people of Hell to Hell. and will vanish from them) meaning what the idolaters worshipped, what they invented) what they worshipped besides Allah that they invented. 431. Say: "Who provides for you from the sky and the earth? Or who owns hearing and sight? And who brings out the living from the dead and brings out the dead from the living? And

who disposes of the affairs?" They will say: "Allah." Say: "Will you not then be afraid (of Allah's punishment)?"} 432. Such is Allah, your Lord in truth. So after the truth, what else can there be, save error? How then are you turned away?} 433 . Thus is the Word of your Lord justified against those who rebel (disobey Allah), that they will not believe.} The Idolaters recognize Allah's Tawhid in Lordship and the Evidence is established against Them through this Recognition. Allah argues that the idolaters' recognition of Allah's Oneness in Lordship is an evidence against them, for which they should admit and recognize the Oneness in divinity and worship. So Allah said: 4>J% 0 4Say: "Who provides for you from the sky and the earth?"} meaning, who is He Who sends down water from the sky and splits the earth with His power and will and allows things to grow from it, £* *^&} 4Is there a god, besides Allah?} [27:62] [Who provides;] ijpja Cy 4Grains. And grapes and clover plants. And olives and date palms. And gardens dense with many trees. And fruits and herbage>"[80:27-31] 4fay o] tiJji jil; 4"Who is he that can provide for you if He should withhold His provision?} [67:21] Allah's statement,

HCvjlj iOr who owns hearing and sight?} means that Allah is the One who granted you the power of sight and hearing. If He willed otherwise, He would remove these gifts and deprive you of them. Similarly, Allah said: iSay it is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing and seeing.} [67:23] Allah also said: ifA pza 53 ii iSay: "Tell me, if Allah took away your hearing and your sight,} [6:46] Then Allah said: * S*& iAnd who brings out the living from the dead and brings out the dead from the living?} by His great power and grace. s? wi iAnd who disposes of the affairs?} In Whose Hand is the dominion of everything? Who protects all, while against Whom there is no protector? Who is the One who judges with none reversing His judgement? Who is the One that is not questioned about what He does while they will be questioned? 4 j* /Wf iWhosoever is in the heavens and on earth begs of Him . Every day He is (engaged) in some affair!}\55:29) The upper and lower kingdoms and what is in them both, including the angels, humans, and Jinn are in desperate need of Him. They are His servants and are under His control. jJjillj} iThey will say: "Allah"} they say this knowingly and they

admit it. jfc} iSay: 'Will you not then be afraid (of Allah's punishment)?"} meaning, don't you fear Him when you worship others because of your ignorance and false opinions? Allah then said: %& £jjS> iSuch is Allah your Lord in truth.} This Lord that you admitted is the One Who does all this, is your Lord and the True Deity that deserves to be worshipped alone. &U\$X 'jZtC} ^So after the truth, what else can there be, save error?} any one worshipped other than Him is false, for there is no God but Allah, He Has no partners. <£* 'M 4How then are you turned away?} How then can you turn away from His worship to worship others while you know that He is the Lord that has created everything, the One who controls and governs everything? Allah then said: ^} 4Thus is the Word of your Lord justified against those who rebel,} These idolaters disbelieved and continued to practice their Shirk, and worship

others beside Allah. But they knew that He is the Creator, the Sustainer and the only One of authority and control in this universe, the One Who sent His Messengers to single Him out for all worship. As they disbelieved and were persistent in their Shirk, Allah's Word proved true and was justified that they would be miserable inhabitants of the Fire. Allah said: 4They will say: "Yes," but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} [39:71]

603Surah 10. Yunus (34 - 36) (Part-11) dSHifi Y 'r ^ 'M OSLA^io*0 opu> (fejyjuuu -JLp jy_^- jlpLjJSAi»^i\^>yjij^l \$?*}ijfakjA\^>j{*4._» . /^V, <f > » >.,^..< >.^ - t>^> ~1lh . .Ol(^«IjCO ^&J*&S^yErr^%cr3.<yrrz> ^ S;j. m!>'C < >* .-<*&»< •'r-f-i-'-vr: ' >-" •? Si ijr ^ «o; > jfr & i fc£ y jELt \$fjo^& jis 'f jj2i 4*JI Ji u* iii J _.' --'I ., ,1, > o^i; ,>»»' i£»"i >^t: "N <J * \$ g J &1 £H jl #£ a &£ ol V'l *£ VI >#ig c; f #H Ss <£ v *J6 l[& Uj *k\ o^ lili 4\$#S <34. Say: "Is there of your partners one that originates the creation and then repeats it?" Say: "Allah originates the creation and then He repeats it. Then how are you deluded away (from the truth)?"} 435. Say: "Is there of your partners one that guides to the truth?" Say: "It is Allah Who guides to the truth. Is then He Who guides to the truth more worthy to be followed, or he who finds not guidance (himself) unless he is guided? Then, what is the matter with you? How judge you?"} 436. And most of them follow nothing but conjecture. Certainly, conjecture can be of no avail against the truth. Surely, Allah is All-Aware of what they do.} This invalidates and falsifies their claims for committing Shirk with Allah and worshipping different idols and rivals. iks? iSay: "Is there of your partners one that originates the creation

and then repeats it?"} meaning, who is the one who started the creation of these heavens and earth and created all the creatures in them? Who can place the planets and the stars in their positions? Who can then repeat the process of the creation? iSay: "Allah"} It is He Who does this. He does it by Himself, alone without partners. i"Then how are you deluded away (from the truth)?"} How is it that you are so misled from the right path to falsehood? 44*4 JI Or. & ot j> iSay: "Is there of your partners one that guides to the truth?" Say: " It is Allah who guides to the truth..".} You know that your deities are incapable of guiding those who are astray. It is Allah alone Who guides the misled and confused ones and turns the hearts from the wrong path to the right path. It is Allah, none has the right to be worshipped but He. ^ ^ ifi (ft ^ <5*^ 4**^ 41 ils then He Who guides to the truth more worthy to be followed, or he who finds not guidance (himself) unless he is guided?} Will the servant then follow the one who guides to the truth so that he may see after he was blind, or follow one who doesn't guide to anything except towards blindness and muteness? Allah said that Ibrahim said: £ Sfj Vj £* C *1s> 40 my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?} (19:42] And said to his people

605Surah 10. Yunus (36 - 37) (Part-11) iWorship you that which you (yourselves) carve? While Allah has created you and what you make!} [37: 95-96] Also, there are many Ayat in this regard. Allah then said: iThen, what is the matter with you? How judge you?}

What is the matter with you? What has happened to your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2475–2494]

mind? How did you make Allah's creatures equal to Him? What kind of judgement did you make to turn away from Allah and worship this or that? Why did you not worship the Lord - Glorified be He, the True King, the Judge and the One Who guides to the truth? Why didn't you call upon Him alone and turn towards Him? Allah then explained that they did not follow their own religion out of evidence and proof. The fact is that they were following mere conjecture and imagination. But conjecture is in no way a substitute for the truth. At the end of this Ayah. He said. 4Allah is All-Aware of what they do.} This is both a threat and a promise of severe punishment. Allah said that He would reward them for their actions with a complete reward. 437. And this Qur'an is not such as could ever be produced by other than Allah but it is a confirmation of (the revelation) which was before it, and a full explanation of the Book - wherein there is no doubt - from the Lord of all that exists.} 438. Or do they say: "He has forged it?" Say: "Bring then a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you can besides Allah, if you are truthful!"} 439. Nay, they have belied the knowledge whereof they could

606 Tafsir Ibn Kathir not comprehend and what has not yet been fulfilled. Thus those before them did belie. Then see what was the end of the wrongdoers!) 440. And of them there are some who believe therein; and of them there are some who believe not therein, and your Lord is All-Aware of the mischief-makers.) The Qur'an is the True, Inimitable Word of Allah and It is a Miracle The Qur'an has a miraculous nature that cannot be imitated. No one can produce anything similar to the Qur'an, nor ten Surahs or even one Surah like it. The eloquence, clarity, precision and grace of the Qur'an cannot be but from Allah. The great and abundant principles and meanings within the Qur'an - which are of great benefit in this world and for the Hereafter - cannot be but from Allah. There is nothing like His High Self and Attributes or like His sayings and actions. Therefore His Words are not like the words of His creatures. This is why Allah said: <jj i&AH o' O'O**^ ob l*jf iAnd this Qur'an is not such as could ever be produced by other than Allah) meaning, a book like this cannot be but from Allah. This is not similar to the speech uttered by humans. 5 jofZ gfif) i but it is a confirmation of (the revelation) which was before it,) Such as previous revelations and Books. The Qur'an confirms these books and is a witness to them. It shows the changes, perversions and corruption that have taken place within these Books. Then Allah said, i and a full explanation of the Book - wherein there is no doubt - from the Lord of all that exists.) That is, fully and truly explaining and detailing the rules and the lawful and the unlawful. With this complete and more than sufficient explanation, the Qur'an leaves no doubt that it

is from Allah, the Lord of all that exists. Allah says, ft o) U & V JXLX # \f% jiXA j\$b 3 i,j\ >& \$} iOr do they say: "He has forged it?" Say: "Bring then a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you can besides Allah, if you are truthful!"} If you argue, claim and doubt whether this is from Allah then you uttered a lie and blasphemy, and you say it is from Muhammad - Muhammad 3^5 , however is a man like you, and since he came as you claim with this Qur'an - then you produce a Surah like one of its Surahs. Produce something of the same nature and seek help and support with all the power you have from humans and Jinns. This is the third stage, Allah challenged them and called them to produce a counterpart of the Qur'an if they were truthful in their claim that it was simply from Muhammad jg. Allah even suggested that they seek help from anyone they chose. But He told them that they would not be able to do it. They would have no way of doing so. Allah said: jij , 0% v #81 ui jl* i)t ol £ SJii ^ f} | *T- iSay : "If the mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could not produce the like thereof, even if they helped one another."} [17:88] Then He reduced the number for

them to ten Surahs similar to it, in the beginning of Surah Hud, Allah said: *»< ojj ot cr4 « yU Ji fly ^ o' iOr they say, "Heforged it." Say: "Bring you then ten forged Surah like unto it, and call whomsoever you can, other tlmn Allah, ifyou speak the truth!"}[11:13] In this Surah He went even further to challenge them to produce only one Surah like unto the Qur'an. So He said: ft oju 4jxx # \pj saX f}

iOr do they say: "He has forged it?" Say: "Bring that a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you can besides Allah, ifyou are truthful!"} (10:38) He also challenged them in Surat Al-Baqarah, a Madinite Surah, to produce one Surah similar to it. He stated in that Surah that they would never be capable of doing so, saying: ij&i ijiuIS Jj ij&3 iBut if you do it not, and you can never do it, then fear the Fire (Hell).>[2:24] It should be noted here that eloquence was a part of the nature and character of the Arabs. Arabic poetry including Al- Mu'allaqat - the oldest complete collection of the most eloquent ancient Arabic poems - was considered to be the best in the literary arts. However Allah sent down to them something whose style none were familiar with, and no one is equal in stature to imitate. So those who believed among them, believed because of what they knew and felt in the Book, including its beauty, elegance, benefit, and fluency. They became the most knowledgeable of the Qur'an and its best in adhering to it. The same thing happened to the magicians during Fir'awn's time. They were knowledgeable of the arts of sorcery, however, when Musa performed his miracles, they knew that it must have come through someone that was supported and guided by Allah. They knew that no human could perform such acts without the permission of Allah. Similarly, isa was sent at the time of scholarly medicine and during the advancement in the treatment of patients. He healed the blind, lepers and raised the dead to life by Allah's leave. What Isa was able to do was such that no form of treatment or medicine could reproduce. As a result, those who believed in him knew that he was Allah's servant and His Messenger. Similarly, in the Sahih, Allah's Messenger jfe said, ij* jS ^ Ir? \ !>? Is? Iri •liu o jl J-jli 5ii oU-jl G-j !Lj\ ^jJi h's iThere was never a Prophet but he was given signs by which the people would recognize him, and that which I was given is

609Surali 10. Yunus (37 - 40) (Part-11 revelation that Allah revealed, so I hope that I will have the mostfollowers among them .n' Allah then said: Uj ijU)4 j?» ihlay, they have belied the knowledge whereof they could not comprehend and what has not yet been fulfilled.} They did not believe in the Qur'an and they have not yet grasped it or comprehended it. 4 pih. iAtid what has not yet been fulfilled.} They have not attained the guidance and the true religion. So they belied it out of ignorance and foolishness. iThose before them did belie.} meaning, the past nations, !l iTheti see what was the end of the wrongdoers!} Look at how we Destroyed them because they denied Our Messengers in their wickedness, pride, stubbornness and ignorance. So beware you who deny the message that the same end will befall you. Allah's statement, 4-* ji.y> j iAnd ofthem there are some who believe therein ;} means that among those you were sent to, O Muhammad, are people who will believe in this Qur'an, follow you and benefit from what has been sent to you. 44 V ^&>} iand of them there are some who believe not therein,} but dies as a disbeliever and will be resurrected as such. tiltjj} 4And your Lord is All-Aware of the mischiefmakers.} 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:619.

He best knows those who deserve guidance, so He guides them, and those who deserve to go astray, He allows to go astray. Allah is, however, the Just who is never unjust. He gives everyone what they deserve. All Glory is His, the Exalted. There is no God but He. pj 4& 4S3T&& % SpJ "fiZ fa u*^ %

i>tj j oJit Jib o' fa> (tyij V ii' ol <41. And i/ they belie you, say: "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!"} 442. And among them are some who listen to you, but can you make the deaf to hear - even though they apprehend not?} 443. And among them are some who look at you, but can you guide the blind - even though they see not?} 444. Truly, Allah wrongs not mankind in aught; but mankind wrong themselves.} imaz TU ^ ^*44-5 / , *>V . >•/f < / sSS \ ^ ^ >< »*>.< uMiP0

TheCommand to be Free and Clear from the Idolaters Allah said to His Prophet jg: If these idolaters belie you, then be clear from them and their deeds.' iSay: "For me are my deeds and far you are your deeds!"} Similarly, Allah said: iSay: "O you disbelievers! I worship not that which you worship."^[109:1-2] to the end of the Surah. Ibrahim Al-Khalil (the Friend) and his followers said to the idolaters among their people: y_H Ji 6/iL "SL. } iVerily, we are free from you and whatever you worship besides Allah} [60:4] Allah then said: 4And among them are some who listen to you,} They listen to your beautiful talk and to the Glorious Qur'an. They listen to your truthful, eloquent and authentic Hadiths that are useful to the hearts, the bodies and their faith. This is indeed a great benefit and is sufficient. But guiding the people to the truth is not up to you or to them. You cannot make the deaf hear. Therefore you cannot guide these people except if Allah wishes. iAnd among them are some who look at you,} They look at you and at what Allah has given you in terms of dignity, noble personality and great conduct. There is in all of this clear evidence of your prophethood to those who have reason and insight. Other people also look but they do not receive guidance like them. Believers look at you with respect and dignity while disbelievers regard you with contempt. 4h>-* yi lijl ify}

4And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery.)(25:41] Then Allah announces that He is never unjust with anyone. He guides whomever He wills and opens the eyes of the blind, makes the deaf hear and removes neglect from the hearts. At the same time He lets others go astray, moving away from faith. He does all of that yet He is always Just, for He is the Ruler and has full authority over His kingdom. He does whatever He wills without any restrictions. No one can question Him as to what He does while he will question everyone else. He is Omniscient, All-Wise, and All-Just. So Allah said: s@Wo& v ith) iTruly, Allah wrongs not mankind in aught; but mankind wrong themselves.) In the Hadith narrated by Abu Dharr, he states that the Prophet related that His Lord, Exalted and High is He, said: ^^ ^Ji pwi JI l&b V «0 My servant! I have prohibited oppression for Myself and made it prohibited for you, so do not oppress one another...» Until He said at the end of the Hadith: \js- XZ-j clftljJ (J ^ t'cjc V1 Jib «0My servants! It is but your deeds that I reckon for you and then recompense you for. So let him who finds good (in the Hereafter) praise Allah. And let him who finds other than that blame no one but himself.»,1! The complete version was recorded by Muslim. ^& tjar yt ^ sc, \js }\$£& 445. And on the Day when He shall gather them together, (it will be) its if they had not stayed (in the life of this world and I 1 * Muslim 4 :1994.

graves) but an hour of a day. They will recognize each other. Ruined indeed will be those who denied the meeting with Allah and were not guided.> The Feeling of Brevity toward the Worldly Life at the Gathering on the Day of Resurrection To remind people of the establishment of the Hour and their resurrection from their graves to the gathering for the Day of Judgment, Allah says: 4And on the Day when He shall gather (resurrect) them.} Similarly Allah said: 4On the Day when they will see that

(torment) with which they are promised (threatened, it will be) as if they had not stayed more than an hour in a single day.>[46:35] Allah also said: iThe Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning.} [79:46] (*4-^ ihj*i j} Ojlljii tL j&1 4The Day when the Trumpet will be blown (the second blowing) : that Day, We shall gather the criminals, blue eyed. They will speak in a very low voice to each other (saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten (days)." We know very well what they will say, when the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day!"} [20:102-104] and. ti ft** ffJT iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour.>[30:55] These all are evidence of the brevity of the worldly life

compared to the Hereafter. Allah said: f ly> btJ yii J-1-* - ufj^ <j pi” ^ j *i V 1 0> 4He (Allah) will say: "What number of years did you stay on earth?" They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account." He (Allah) will say: "You stayed not but a little, if you had only known!"} [23:112-124] Alldh then said: 4pr5 iThey will recognize each other} The children will know their parents and relatives will recognize one another. They will know them just like they used to know them during the life in this world. However, on that Day everyone will be busy with himself. Allah then said: iThen, when the Trumpet is blown , there will be no kinship among f/iem.\$>[23:101] Allah also said: Xf *5®4 4And no friend will ask a friend (about his condition) .}[70:10] Allah then said: '-•j\$ &k &} iRuined indeed will be those who denied the meeting with Allah and were not guided.} This is similar to the Ayah: 4Woe that Day to the deniers.}[77:15] Woe to them because they will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. That is indeed the great loss. There is no loss greater than the loss of one who will be taken away from his dear ones on the Day of Grief and Regret. *& -v r

^46. Whether We show you some of what We promise them (the torment), or We cause you to die - still unto Us is their return, and moreover Allah is Witness over what they used to do.} 447. And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes, the matter will be judged between them with justice, and they will not be wronged.} The Criminals will certainly be avenged - whether in This World or in the Hereafter Allah said to His Messenger 0/. ^)j} 4Whether We show you some of what We promise them (the torment),} We shall avenge them in your lifetime so your eye will be delighted. 40r We cause you to die - still unto Us is their return,} Allah will then be the Witness watching over their actions for you. Allah then said, 4And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes,} Mujahid said: "This will be on the Day of Resurrection." iThe matter will be judged between them with justice,} is similar to the Ayah: iAnd the earth iwill shine with the light of its Lord (Allah),} [39:69] (il Al-Tabari 15:99.

So every nation will be presented before Allah in the presence of its Messenger and the Book of its deeds. All good and evil deeds will be witnessed upon them. Their guardian angels will be witnesses too. The nations will be brought forth, one by one. Our noble Ummah, while it is the last of the nations, is the first one on the Day of Resurrection to be questioned and judged. This was stated by Allah's Messenger ^ in a Hadith recorded by both Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Allah's Messenger afe said: «We are the last, the first on the Day of Resurrection . We will be judged before the rest of the creatures .» [I1 His Ummah attains the honor of precedence only by the honor of its Messenger jg, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him forever, until the Day of Judgement. Ji l&liiyjjC-J Vj *e\h l1 it lj[J<3 jil ill!

jLi 'Jr. 4 £ c ill \$ J-^4 Ilu £ui >A/ / < ^ // » £ > » <» **S ^V «J/ L*j oj>j^ (J-* Ijjj uyJJ j 448. And they say: "When will be this promise (the torment or the Day of Resurrection) , if you speak the truth?" } 449. Say: "I have no power over any harm or profit for myself except what Allah may will. For every Ummah, there is a term appointed; when their term comes, neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment)." } 450. Say: "Tell me, if His torment should come to you by night or by day, which portion thereof would the criminals hasten on?" } 451. Is it then that when it has actually befallen, you will believe in it? What! Now (you believe)? And you used (aforetime) to hasten it on!" } Fath Al-Bari 6 :595 , and Muslim 2 :585

617 Surah 10. Yunus (48 - 52) (Part-11 452. Then it will be said to them who wronged themselves: "Taste you the everlasting torment! Are you recompensed (ought) save what you used to earn?" } The Deniers of the Day of Resurrection wish to hasten its Coming and their Response Allah told us about the idolaters who reject faith through their demand that the punishment be hastened, inquiring about the time of punishment. The response to such question is not inherently beneficial, yet they inquired anyway. Allah said: iTwse who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth. } [42:18] They know that it is the truth for it is definitely going to happen. It is going to take place even if they have no idea when it will occur. This is why Allah instructed His Messenger jg to answer them saying: % \% y \$ } \$ Say : "I have no power over any harm or profit to myself." } [10:49, 7:188] I will not say except what He has taught me. I also have no authority over anything that Allah has not shown to me. I am Allah's servant and His Messenger to you. I was told that the Hour is going to come, but He has not told me when it will occur. But, ^& } iFor every Utmah, there is a term appointed; } meaning that for every generation or community there is a set term appointed for them. When the end of that term approaches, ;neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment). }

619 Surah 10. Yunus (53 - 54) (Part-11) J) ii»is »<• assas A«f3*\$iA&S Si*^^3a^S^3«Sk ifiittSMJ&tf0'oJZ . *r-» . -5f y* + * . \$ 5Eat 477ie Day w/ien they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. This is the Fire that you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste you therein its heat and whether you are patient of it or im- patient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you used to do. } [52:13-16) 4 \$ %& o*3 } \ 4 £ cJ&i yyi y ji> scat 4 oxiv 4* \$i53i lit; a' 4^1^ . *£ 453. And they ask you to inform them (saying): "Is it true?" Say : "Yes! By my Lord! It is the very truth! And you cannot escape it!" } 454. And if every person who had wronged, possessed all that is on the earth and sought to ransom himself therewith (it will not be accepted), and they would feel in their hearts regret when they see the torment, and they will be judged with justice, and no wrong will be done unto them. } The Resurrection is Real Allah said that they ask you to inform them (saying):

622 Surah 10. Yunus (55 - 58) (Part-11) belongs to Allah. No doubt, surely, Allah's promise is true. But most of them know not. } 456. It is He Who gives life, and causes death, and to Him you (all) shall return. } Allah is the Owner of the heavens and earth. His promise is true and is indeed going to be fulfilled. He is the One Who gives life and causes death. To Him is the return of everyone, and He is the One who has the power over that, and the One Who knows everything about every creature; its deterioration, and where every speck of it has gone, be it land, oceans or otherwise. 4 d tSij fij a; fi-K %

j.m \$£> Y * ^ o' > <. * + "*"// if 457. O mankind! There has come to you good advice from your Lord, and a cure for that which is in your breasts, - a guidance and a mercy for the believers.} 458. Say: "In the bounty of Allah, and in His mercy; therein let them rejoice." That is better than what (the wealth) they amass.} The Qur'an is an Admonition, Cure, Mercy and Guidance Allah confers a great favor on His creatures in what He has sent down of the Gracious Qur'an to His Noble Messenger He said: It diffp , £3fC d J-di \$£} 40 mankind! There has come to you good advice from your Lord.} A warning and a shield from shameful deeds. 4j/x^\ 4 d, •&£} 4 and a cure for that which is in your breasts,} A cure from suspicion and doubts. The Qur'an removes all the filth and Shirk from the hearts. 4a guidance and a mercy} The guidance and the mercy from

623 Surah 10. Yunus (59 - 60) (Part-11) bin Zayd bin Aslam and others said: "This Ayah was revealed to criticize the idolaters for what they used to make lawful and unlawful. Like the Bahirah J * Sd'ibah^ and WasUah.'^ As Allah said: ^ JI , * ^ y * Iji U-j 4 Ami they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. \$[6:136] Imam Ahmad recorded a narration from Malik bin Nadlah who said, "I came to Allah's Messenger gg while in filthy clothes. He said, , \ «?<JU dJJ J*» a Do you have wealth I answered, 'Yes.' He said, \ «?JU \$& V o what kind of wealth?» I answered, 'All camels, slaves, horses, sheep.' So he said, 'J& YU iill \ \ • If Allah Jf° es y°u we(dth, then let it be seen on you .» Then he said, •Jii :jjp ' ' l*- 1*-? dLl| £~< j*' , r^ | | "*" # ' ** > • ' , *1 ^ | " ' | > jl' * * «/f is not that VPur came^s are horn with healthy ears, you take a knife and cut tkf 11' saV' " ^ I * s , s a Bohr," tear its skin, — then say, 'This is ? ? arm/' and prohibit them for yourself and your family?> \ I replied, 'Yes.' He stfjd ' * ' \ i i fj* J>-l <U Ul se mil^ was spared for the idols and nobody was A 8 he-camel whose allowed to milk it. A she-camel let loose for the free Pasture of their false g°ds and nothing was allowed to be c carried on it. (3) A she-camel set free for ido ' ? 8 because u has ^ ven birth to a she" camel at its first delivery and ^ then a Sain give 8 birth to a ah6"0®" 161 at its second delivery. At-Tabar.^ 15:1 12-1 13

°What Allah has given you is lawful. Allah's Forearm is stronger than your forearm, and Allah's knife is sharper than your knife And he mentioned the Hadith in its complete form, and the chain for this Hadith is a strong, good chain. Allah criticized those who make lawful what Allah has made unlawful or vice versa. This is because they are based on mere desires and false opinions that are not supported with evidence or proof. Allah then warned them with a promise of

the Day of Resurrection. He asked:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2494–2538]

{And what think tlwse who invent a lie against Allah, on the Day of Resurrection?} What do they think will happen to them when they return Us on the Day of Resurrection? Ibn Jarir said that Ally's statement: {Truly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind,} indicated that the bounty is in postponing their Pun'shment in this world. 121 I (Ibn Kathir) say, the meaning could be t^at the Grace for people is in the good benefits that He made permissible for them in this world or in their r^jjgjon also has not prohibited them except what is haj^ ^ il to them in their world and the Hereafter. i&z J {but most of them are ungrateful.} So they/prohibited what Allah has bestowed upon them and made it ^ narrow upon themselves. They made some thin|g lawfui and others unlawful. The idolaters committed thes|j actions when they set laws for themselves. And so did the R le Qf the Book when they invented innovations in

their relief „77‘On. *1 &JT- 'll ii, iji2 Cj 4 ojfe cr- 4 V_> J?ji\ ,) yji ffyJ 111 Afimad 3:473, 4:136. At-Jabari 15:113. . M & V>*i M

461 . Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, but We are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord (so much as) the weight of a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not what is less than that or what is greater than that but is (written) in a Clear Record.} Everything Small or Large is within the Knowledge of Allah Allah informed His Prophet jfe that He knows and is well acquainted with all of the affairs and conditions of him and his Ummah and all of creation and its creatures at all times - during every hour and second. Nothing slips or escapes from His knowledge and observation, not even anything the weight of a speck of dust within the heavens or earth, or anything that is smaller or larger than that. Everything is in a manifest Book, as Allah said: . <" .M *->jj v. 4And with Him are the keys of the Ghayb (all that is hidden and unseen), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is in the land and in the sea; not a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.>(6:59) He stated that He is Well-Aware of the movement of the trees and other inanimate objects. He is also Well-Aware of all grazing beasts. He said: ft% 4 £>> o;O iThere is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are communities like you.} (6:38) He also said: uj»jV> 4 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due

Jr rn Ejv , !&&&&&0ju£%\$£\$^d AdSffi0isflyzity JofjVf> £(j*J iui> mm3 %^from Alldh.}(U:6) If this is His knowledge of the movement of these things, then what about His knowledge of the movement of the creatures that are commanded to worship Him? Allah said: ^3t £ /{*// .o, > ^ IffippiS <ilb£ cfj)t 4And puf your irusf in file Almighty, the Most Merciful, Who sees you when you stand up, and your movements among those who fall prostrate>(26:217-219) That is why Allah said: i[IjjJi (jii £i sjtwu 1?) ji ii. ijb dj£ tj 0^5 . <• > .4 4Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, butWe are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it.} meaning, *We are watching and hearing you when you engage in that thing.' When Jibril asked the Prophet jg about Ihsan, he said: oly |»J Oii <oly «^Ut^ ill JuiJ of «Jf is that you worship Allah as if you are seeing Him. But since you do not see Him, be certain that He is watching you.» f| Muslim 1 :37

-j Jii ibji Ol 5j2t >05 viN jj£ V J^ST 05 iS?* 4^ 4®^ <62. Behold! The Awliydh' of Allah, no fear shall come upon them nor shall they grieve 463. Those who believed, and have Taqwa.} 464. For them is good news, in the life of the present world, and in the Hereafter. No change can there be in the Words of Allah. This is indeed the supreme success> Identifyingthe Awliydh* ofAllah Allah tells us that His Awliya' (friends and allies) are those who believe and have Taqwa of Allah as He defined them. Every pious. God-fearing person is a friend of Allah, therefore, 4-0® ino fear shall come upon them\$ from the future horrors they will face in the Hereafter. inor shall they grieve over anything left behind in this world. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah's Messenger said: tdti i ^Li; iSc* «ii jeW •Among the servants of Allah there will be those whom the Prophets and the martyrs will considerfortunate». It was said: "Who are these, O Messenger of Allah, so we may love them?" He said: he ij* jj ^5 J'3^ ff hi Jt fj* p-6 ' •^iUl lij IS) jjiUw N »jji «These are people who loved one another for the sake of Allah without any other interest like money or kinship. Their faces will be light, upon

platforms of light. They shall have no fear (on that Day) when fear shall come upon people. Nor shall they

grieve when others grieve.» Then he recited: £ ,\T , (*% —>y- "3 *i' »t!j' iBehold!! Verily, the Awliyid' (friends and allies) of Allah, no fear shall come upon them nor shall they grieve.}^ The True Dream is a Form of Good News Ibn Jarir narrated from Tjbadah bin As-Samit that he [recited] to Allah's Messenger jg: iiU^ CSif 4 #31W iFor them is good news, in the life of the present world, and in the Hereafter.} [and said,] "We know the good news of the Hereafter, it is Paradise. But what is the good news in this world?" He said: S' l*A ifi *A -J iS~y ***!' '-"Si tS'Jl 8 •jjr 1 ' Cri KA AaA *It is the good dream that a servant may see or it is seen about him. This dream is one part from forty-four or seventy parts of Prophethood .»*2' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr said, "O Messenger of Allah! What about a man who does deeds that the people commend him for?" Allah's Messenger jg said, » tSj^ . silk8 iThat is the good news that has been expedited for the believer. »3 Imam. Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that Allah's Messenger jg said: iFor them is good news, in the life of the present world} Then ' l ' At-Tabari 15:120. See Also Abu Dawud no. 3527. For an understanding of its interpretation , see Path Al-Bari, no . 6983 [2] At-Tabari 15:132. ' Ahmad 5:156, and Muslim 4:2034.

629Surah 10. Yunus (62 - 64) (Part-11) he said. O** 04 ^'Jr 5*^5 04 tye '04.^ 1 *— *'jh jUa-^J l y> UJji »ilJS ijff i 1\$ j ^~*Uls liiJi 4I) l^j j~>u Vj I'jjQj i ;jLU (^p uThe good dream that comes as a good news for the believer is a part of forty-nine parts of prophethood . So if anyone of you has a good dream, he should narrate it to others. But if he has a dream that he dislikes, then it is from Shaytan to make him sad. He should blow to his left three times, and say : "Allahu Akbar," and should not mention it to anyone."s*11 And it was also said, "The good news here is the glad tidings the angels bring to the believer at the time of death. They bring him the good news of Paradise and forgiveness." Similarly, Allah said: UP% \j& p3 & <j4 Vj* £ i+j 'Spj zjfZJz u ppj iVerily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah (alone)," and then they stand straight and firm, on them the angels will descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised! We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and therein you shall have (all) for which you ask. An entertainment from (Allah), the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful/> (41:30-32) In the Hadith narrated by Al-Bara', the Prophet 3g said: : lyiii o*?. ISI jl St* 04 &*** 'OUi* fi- *->jj oUJj cLj! £j*J\ KgS "When death approaches the believer, angels with white faces (M Ahmad 5 :219.

and white clothes come to him and say: "O good soul! Come out to comfort and provision and a Lord who is not angry." The soul then comes out of his mouth like a drop of water pouring out of a water skinM Their good news in the Hereafter is as Allah said: iThe greatest terror (on the Day of Resurrection) will not grieve them, and the angels will meet them, (with the greeting:) "This is your Day which you were promised."} (21:103), and. V? 6 & fir' >*r*dy rpjV 'Aj {J.Y 2&& fe U£~ 'Jr\$ f.'Ax iOn the Day you shall see the believing men and the believing women - their light running forward before them and by their right hands. Glad tidings for you this Day! Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell therein forever! Truly, this is the great success!}[57:12) Allah then said: 4No change can there be in the Words of Allah.} meaning, this promise doesn't change or breach or fall short. It is decreed and firm, and going to happen undoubtedly. iThis is indeed the supreme success.} P

A ^ 'Jh CL—*. A A PPP "Aj} Oi CjM Jj- 5! bj OfjVt^ CA) ^ i£=a&p& 45 a u* v. 4%90& k jV&i 111 Ahmad 4:287.

631 Surah 10. Yunus (65 - 67) <Part-11 4.65. Do not grieve over their speech, for all power and honor belong to Allah. He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} 466. Behold! Verily, to Allah belongs whosoever is in the heavens and whosoever is in the earth. And those who worship and invoke others besides Allah, in fact they fallow not the partners, they fallow only a conjecture and they do nothing but lie.} 467. He it is Who has appointed for you the night that you may rest therein, and the day to make things visible (to you). Verily, in this are Ayat for a people who listen (those who think deeply).} All Might and Honor is for Allah — He Alone has Full Authority within the Universe Allah said to His Messenger jg, 4-&&A %} 4 Do not grieve} because of the remarks of these idolaters, and depend on Allah and ask for His help. Put your trust in Him. 4l 3j*Jl 4 For all power and honor belong to Allah.} All might and honor belong to Him, His Messenger jg and the believers. 4*f&yzx& 4 He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} He hears the utterances of His servants and knows their affairs. Allah then stated that to Him is the dominion of the heavens and earth. But the idolaters worship idols, that own nothing and can neither harm nor benefit anyone. They have no evidence to base their worship on them. They only follow their own conjecture, lies, and ultimately - falsehood. Allah then informed us that He is the One Who made the night for His servants to rest therein from weariness and exhaustion. 4 And the day to make things visible (to you).} bright and clear for them to seek livelihood and to travel to

fulfill their needs. 2 j'A9\$MA k i Verily, in this are Ayat for a people who listen. Those who hear these proofs and take a lesson from them. These Ayat can lead them to realize the greatness of their Creator and Sustainer. 4 ta&ft j, uj^ o. c & a &&& 0\$ \$\$\$\$&\$ 'j &A£ <£>)}& oj <£*»*« C,\X& i&J 2 fa? £J> - is n if. If£j5)i 4 ££ V c>0 U & 4:kU£, 468. They say: "Allah has begotten a son." Glory is to Him! He is Rich (free of all needs). His is all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. No warrant have you for this. Do you say against Allah what you know not? 469. Say: "Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful."} 470. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} Allah is Far Above taking a Wife or having Children Allah criticizes those who claim that He has, 4 ...begotten a son. Glory is to Him! He is Rich (Free of all needs).} He is Greater than that and above it. He is Self-Sufficient, free of want or need of anything. Everything else is in desperate need of Him, 4UoV» 4 u; vyli)' ^_X £ 4 His is all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth.} So how can He have a son from what He has created? Everything and everyone belongs to Him and is His servant. 4'H g&L oj ,£=»xe 4^

633 Surah 10. Yunus (68 - 70) (Part-11) 4 No warrant have you for this Meaning, you have no proof for the lies and falsehood that you claim, V C jj! Je 4 Do you say against Allah wltwt you know not.} This is a severe threat and a firm warning. Similarly, Allah threatened and said: iij oj jtiZj llli aSI 'a.\s iyfj J Lici iii J ujJu ty J JOl Jtjf Jvjti |Uj*j 4iJ 41. 4 6* <1>^ ,.V,Ulj jjliil' jyj 44C £SvtiS 4A«d they say: "The Most Gracious has begotten a son." Indeed you have brought forth a terribly evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins, tlmt they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious. But it is not suitable for the Most Gracious that He should beget a son. There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a servant. Verily,

He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection.} (19:88-95) Then Allah warned the liars that fabricated the claim that He has begotten a son. He warned that they will not succeed, never prospering in this world or in the Hereafter. In this world Allah will lead them, step-by-step, to their ruin. He will give them respite and put up with them for a while. He will allow them to have little enjoyment, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment. >(31:24) As Allah said here: 4(A brief) enjoyment in this world!} meaning, only a short period,

tw{Jj iiSiKa djJ^iJ}££iiZ‘£*J>ZjiyC) ji ^ illr^‘^j^l < _<< * > ** »>ft. >*' //>'.<">#?^ >-<yU» fl UU^UQjul(j.4^j^j^iij>.Os3 < t ^ -5 *^f ^->rr *j>yKj ^j^t*joy-jk Jj=Jjo_>! J'i 4fi^* £4>i 4«nd tfien unto Us will be their return} on the Day of Resurrection; s*4* Z&& Z&J % 4s>Jj& ij>v^=» iij iThen We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} meaning, ‘We shall make them taste the painful punishment because of their Kufr and lies about Allah.’ 3s *1 gy W '%&\$. Jjb. £&£0 jfe ^ jS c*1j>#^ 4* >1 « £Jba ^Jj 4@a&3 v; cii !£a2& j_J' >-a^£- 4 o*j *j!^» vie 4' cJ 4f:43^ at j^t ^s^ lsr 472. And recite to them the news ofNiih. When he said to his people: "O my people , if my stay (with you), and my reminding (you) of the Aydt ofAllah is hard on you, then I put my trust in Allah . So devise your plot, you and your partners, and let not your plot be in confusion for you. Then pass your sentence on me and give me no respite.} 472. "But if you turn away, then no reward have I asked of you, my reward is only from All&h, and I have been commanded to be of the Muslims."}

635Surah 10. Yunus (71 - 73) (Part-11) 473. They denied him, but We delivered him, and those with him in the ship, and We made them generations, replacing one after another, while We drowned those who belied Our Ayat. Then see what was the end of those who were warned.} The Story ofNuh and His People Allah instructed His Prophet jgjij, saying: 4And recite to them} relate to the disbelievers of the Quraysh who belied you and rejected you, 4the news ofNuh} meaning, his story and news with his people who belied him. Tell them how Allah destroyed them and caused every last one ofthem all to drown. Let this be a lesson for your people, lest they will be destroyed like them. 4When he said to his people : "O my people, ifmy stay (with you), and my reminding (you) of the Ayat ofAllah is hard on you, then I put my trust in Allah."} Meaning, If you find that it is too much of an offense that I should live among you and preach to you the revelation of Allah and His signs and proofs, then I do not care what you think, and I will not stop inviting you.’ devise your plot, you and your partners}, ‘get together with all ofyour deities (idols and statues) thatyou callupon beside Allah,’ 4and let not your plot be in confusion for you} meaning, an‘d do not be confused about this, rather come and let us settle this together ifyou claim thatyou are truthful,’ 4i>£& 4and give me no respite.} T)o not give me respite even for one hour. Whatever you can do, go ahead and do it. I do not care, and 1 do not fear you, because you are not standing on

i: Jtj% % \$\$p m 6' 4When his Lord said to him, "Submit (be a Muslim)!" He said, “I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of all that exists." And this was enjoined by Ibrahim upon his sons and by Ya'qub (saying), "O my sons! Allah has chosen far you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims."^(2:131- 132) Yusuf said: \$My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Guardian in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim, and join

me with the righteous. (12:101) MQsa said: O my people! If you have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him if you are Muslims. (10:84) The magicians said: Our Lord! pour out on us patience, and cause us to die as Muslims. (7:126) Bilqis said: My Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself, and I submit (I have become Muslim) together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists (27:44) Allah said: Verily, We did send down the Tawrah, therein was guidance and light, by which the Prophets, judged far the Jews. (5:44)

Tafkir Ibn Kathir He also said: When 1 (Allah) inspired Al-Hawdriyyin to believe in Me and My Messenger, they said: "We believe. And bear witness that we are Muslims." (5:11) The last of the Messengers and the leader of mankind 3g said: Verily, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying are for Allah, the Lord of all that exists. He has no partner. And of this I have been commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims. (6:162-163) meaning, from this Ummah. He & said, in an authentic Hadith. 1.13 & 3 > rj ^ «We, the Prophets are brothers with (the same father but) different mothers. Our religion is the same, meaning, "we should worship Allah alone without partners while having different laws." The Evil Goal and End of Criminals Allah said: They denied him, but We delivered him, and those with him meaning on his religion, in the (Fulk) ship } Fulk refers to the ark, and, &&> } <We made them generations replacing one after another} on earth, U> k 1*1 Fath Al-Bari 6 :550

Sarah 10. Yunus (73 - 74) (Part-11) 639 Awhile We drowned those who belied Our Ayat. Then see what was the end of those who were warned.} meaning 'O Muhammad, see how We saved the believers and destroyed the deniers!' ui laicJ, is? ^ j+%S Ot bS»! 474. Then after him We sent Messengers to their people. They brought them clear proofs, but they would not believe what they had already rejected beforehand. Thus We seal the hearts of the transgressors.} Meaning; Then after Nuh We sent Messengers to their people. They brought them clear proofs, and evidences of the truth that they came with. 4But they would not believe what they had already rejected beforehand} meaning the nations did not believe what their Messengers brought to them because they already rejected it from the beginning. Allah said: i&a,#4 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance).} (6:110) He then said here, 4Thus We seal the hearts of the transgressors.} This means that as Allah has set seals on the hearts of those people, such that they would not believe since they previously rejected faith, He would also set seals on the hearts of the people that are like them, who will come after them. They would not believe until they see the severe torment. This means that Allah destroyed the nations after Noah. He destroyed the nations that rejected the Messengers and saved those who believed from among them. From the time of Adam to Noah, people followed Islam. Then they invented the worship of idols. So Allah sent Nuh to them. That is why the believers will say to him on the Day of

Resurrection, "You are the first Messenger Allah sent to the people of the earth." Ibn 'Abbas said: "There were ten generations between Adam and Nuh, and all of them were following Islam." 111 Allah also said: 4And how many generations have We destroyed after Nuh! (17: 17) This was a serious warning to the Arab pagans, who rejected the leader and last of the Messengers and Prophets. If the people before them who rejected their Messengers had received this much punishment, then what did they think will happen to them since they perpetrated even greater sins than others before them? ' / -5 •-* f l>j5 i ji Jli UC* o) ijlli Coifr ,3>jt ftStr ilU fcftr:& os& £& *S %& Q <23 4 & aj£j 475. Then after

them We sent Musa and Harun to Fir'awn and his chiefs with Our Aydt. But they behaved arrogantly and were a people who were criminals .) 476. So when came to them the truth from Us, they said: "This is indeed clear magic.") 477 . Musa said: "Say you (this) about the truth when it has come to you? Is this magic? But the magicians will never be successful.") 478. They said: "Have you come to us to turn us away from that we found our fathers following, and that you two may have greatness in the land? We are not going to believe you two!") The Story of Musa and Fira'wn Allah said: 4 Then after them We sent) meaning after these Messengers, Al-Bidayah wan-Nih&yah 1:101, and he said , "Al-Bukhari recorded it .

'&j, d', iMusd and Hdriin to Fir'awn and his chiefs, meaning his people iwith Our Aydt.} meaning; 'Our proofs and evidences.' iBut they behaved arrogantly, and were a people who were criminals.} meaning they were too arrogant to follow the truth and submit to it, and they were criminals. 4ZJ%J& Si\$ ^ &si £{c iSo, when came to them the truth from us, they said : "This is indeed clear magic."} They were as if they gave an oath that what they had said was the truth. But they knew that what they were saying was a mere lie. As Allah said: i<& at^ TSlPJ g. iAnd they belied them wrongfully and arrogantly, though they themselves were convinced thereof.}(27:14) Musa criticized them saying: i"Say you (this) about the truth when it has come to you? Is this magic? But the magicians will never be successful." They said: "Have you come to us to turn us away...} itsac&as &} ifrom that we found our fathers following} their religion. <<& iand that you two may have.. .} 4greatness^ means grandeur and leadership

642 Tafstr Ibn Kathir i...in the land, We are not going to believe you two!"} >43 £. 1333 JjI t \$1 * U fry jis ij\$ *5/ Sat ij| — <11 ol a% V^=* *#~^ { .>33 40^r 479. And Fir'awn said: "Bring me every well-versed sorcerer." 180. And when the sorcerers came, Musa said to them : "Cast down what you want to cast!"} 181 . Then when they had cast down, Musa said: "What you have brought is sorcery, Allah will surely make it of no effect. Verily, Allah does not set right the work of the evildoers.} i82. "And Allah will establish and make apparent the truth by His Words, however much the criminals may hate (it)."} Between Musa and the Magicians Allah mentioned the story of the magicians and MQsa in Surat Al-A'raf (there is a commentary on it in that Surah), this Surah, Surat Ta Ha, and in Surat Ash-Shu'ara Fir'awn, may Allah's curse be upon him, wanted to deceive the people and impress them with the tricks of the magicians in direct opposition to the plain truth that MUsa brought. The result was the exact opposite and he therefore didn't attain his goal. The signs of the Lord prevailed in that public festival. j*£j, JU lytilllij ffrj*>4! Js &&* &&&&0

4 lyy yjl 4i4«d the sorcerers fell down prostrate. They said : "We believe in the Lord of all that exists - the Lord of Musa and Hdrun."}(7:120-122) Fir'awn thought that he would achieve victory through the magicians over the Messenger sent by Allah, the All-Knower of all hidden things. But he failed, lost Paradise and was deserving of the Hellfire. C Iry cffi £ <;^ ^ Fir'awn said: "Bring me every well-versed sorcerer." And when the sorcerers came, Musa said to them : "Cast down what you want to cast!"} They stood in line after they received the promise of Fir'awn to become closer to him and obtain a generous reward. Musa wanted them to begin. He wanted the people to see what the magicians had made, then he would come with the truth after that to triumph over their falsehood. 41>dl Ji d^ 1 !> Jj' J & J Cl iThey said: "O Musa! Either you throw first or we be the first to throw?" [Musa] said : "Nay, throw you (first)!"} When the magicians cast their spells they bewitched the eyes of the people through

their display of mighty sorcery. At that time, [^]tii ***? -4—*> jtr*. <4 C cd iift. £& VJ \£, Uj '£> C m± 4Mud conceived fear in himself. We (Allah) said: "Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand. And throw that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (ofskill) he may attain."} (20:67-69) Upon that, Musa said:

644 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4What you have brought is sorcery, Allah will surely make it of no effect. Verily, Allah does not set right the work of tlte evildoers. And Allah will establish and make apparent the truth by His Words, however much the criminals may hate (it).} \fs Xfek J X+fe'j oi Jy oi S*' ^83. But none believed in Musa except the offspring of his people, because of the fear of Fir'awn and his chiefs, lest they should persecute them; and verily, Fir'awn was an arrogant tyrant on the earth, he was indeed one of the transgressors.} Only a Few Youth from Fir'awn's People believed in Musa Allah tells us that despite all the clear signs and irrefutable evidence Musa came with, only a few offspring from Fir'awn's followers believed in him. They were even scared that Fir'awn and his followers would force them to return to Ku.fr (disbelief). Fir'awn was an evil tyrant and extremely arrogant. His people feared him and his power too much. Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: a y>- 3* **!>• oi 'Jl o*' ^} 4But none believed in Musa except the offspring of his people because of the fear of Fir 'awn and his chiefs, lest they should persecute them.} "The offspring that believed in Musa from Fir'awn's people, other than Banu Israel, were few. Among them were Fir'awn's wife, the believer who was hiding his faith, Fir'awn's treasurer, and his wife." The Children ofIsrael, however, themselves believed in Musa, all of them. They were glad to see him coming. They knew of his description and the news of his advent from their previous Books. They knew that Allah was going to save them through IM At-Tabari 15:164.

him from the capture of Fir'awn and give them power over him. So when this knowledge reached Fir'awn he was very wary. But his caution and weariness didn't help him one bit. When Musa arrived, Fir'awn subjected them to great harm, and ^M 4 4They said: 'We (Children of Israel) suffered troubles before you came to us, and since you have come to us." He said: "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you flcf?>[7:129] The fact that all of the Children Israel became believers is evidenced by the following Ayat. ft<> ft 4& &s Ujj 484. And Musa said: "O my people! Ifyou have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him ifyou are Muslims."} 485. They said: "In Allah we put our trust. Our Lord! Make us not a trialfor thefolk who are wrongdoers.} 486. "And save us by Your mercyfrom the disbelievingfolk."} Musa encouraged His People to put TheirTrust in Allah Allah told us that Milsa said to the Children of Israel: 4o^ ft oi & ft\ ft 4 40 my people! If you have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him ifyou are Muslims.} Allah is sufficient for those who put their trust in Him. 4fe^ J\$} 4Is not Allah sufficientfor His servant?}(39:36) 4fc#&£&£} 4And whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him.}(65:3) Allah combines worship and reliance in many places. He said:

646 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4So worship Him and put your trust in Him.^ (11:123) iSay: "He is the Most Gracious (Allah), in Him we believe, and in Him we put our trust..>(67:29) and :i|s % i[ai v *a5^ 4(He a/one is) the Lord of the east and the west; none has the right to be worshipped but He. So take Him (alone) as a protector.>(73:9) And Allah commanded the believers to say many times in their Salah _j JL-jo jlljt^ 4You (Alone) we worship, and You (Alone) we askfor help (for each and everything).^ (1:5)

The Children of Israel complied with this command and said: 4J&, 'J Cj \$£} iln Allah we put our trust. Our Lord! Make us not a trial for the folk who are wrongdoers.} This means don't give them victory over us so that they rule us. So they might not think that they have authority over us because they were following the truth and we were falsehood. This might be a deceiving trial for them. This meaning was reported from Abu Mijliz and Abu Ad-Duha,¹¹¹ 'Abdur-Razzaq, in a narration from Mujahid, said, ? 4& £iiosH£> iOur Lord! Make us not a trial for the folk who are wrongdoers} meaning, "Do not give them authority over us so they might make us fall into Fitnah."12' Allah's statement: 111 At-Tabari 15:169. 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :297

{And save us by Your mercy} means save us through Your mercy and beneficence ifrom the disbelieving folk.} meaning, from those who denied the truth and covered it. We truly have believed in You and put our trust in You. tjLiir ^87. And We revealed to Musa and his brother (saying): "Provide dwellings for your people in Egypt, and make your dwellings as places for your worship, and perform the Saldh, and give glad tidings to the believers."} Theywerecommanded to pray inside TheirHomes Allah tells us why He saved the Children of Israel from Fir'awn and his people. He tells us how he saved them. Allah commanded Mttsa and his brother HarQn to take houses for their people in Egypt, iand make your dwellings as placesfar your worship,} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, while interpreting this Ayah: "The Children of Israel said to MQsa, We cannot offer our prayers in public in front of Fir'awn's people.' So Allah permitted them to pray in their houses. They were commanded to build their houses in the direction of the Qiblah. Mujahid commented, iUfMS!>> iand make your dwellings as placesfar your worship,} When Banu Israel feared that Fir'awn might kill them in their gatherings at their temples, they were commanded to take their houses as places of worship. The houses should be facing the Qiblah and the prayer could be in secret."121 This was stated by Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak as well.¹³¹ 111 At-Tabari 15:174. 121 Ibid. 131 At-Tabari 15:173.

6M Tafstr Ibn Kathir • -/ >£<«». * ^4 J>*y Vy ? o® Ui % #' Jtje Gj liljpp «i*- £ jit>5 G js .^jjVf v'ii' j£ Vj U -ji .—'j L^~^jjcj . ~ * ..wt V <<# \$& X '*&>0>j-*i 488. And Musa said: "Our Lord! You have indeed bestowed on Fir'-awn and his chiefs spleti- dor and wealth in the life of this world, our Lord! That they may lead men astray from Your path. Our Lord! Destroy their wealth, and harden their hearts, so that they will not believe until they see the painful torment."4 489. Allah said: "Verily, the invocation ofyou both is accepted. So you both keep to the straight way, and follow not the path of those who know not."\$ Musa supplicated against Fir'awn and His Chiefs Allah mentioned what Musa said when he prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs after they refused to accept the truth. They continued to go astray and be haughty and arrogant. MUsa said: i&j 'fc <Z?j, o#C 40ur Lord! You have indeed bestowed on Fir'awn and his chiefs splendor and pleasure of this worldly life. r\, .-Ail JAJi > <- ' * tV >> />•<•. »> 'AX'. \$}> .. if>xTx ^

iand wealth} plentiful and abundant. Allah's statement, Jz '0/ Qjlf i^Lt £} iin the li/e of this world, Our Lord! That they may lead men astrayfrom Your path.} was read with the word *LiyadiM" and "Liyudillu." The first is with a Fathah over the Yd, meaning that "You have given them that while You know they would not believe in what You have sent me with to them. You did that so they would gradually be drawn away from the truth." As Allah said: ithat We may test them thereby.}{20:131) and (72:17). Others read the word with a Dammah over the Yd. (i.e. Liyudillu) This makes the Ayah mean:

You have given them that so whoever You willed from among Your creatures will be tried. Those whom You wish to misguide would think that You have given them that because You loved them and You cared about them.” i"Our Lord! Destroy their wealth/”} Ibn ‘Abbas and Mujahid said: “They asked Allah to destroy their wealth.” Ad-Dahhak, Abu Al-‘Aliyah and Ar-Rabfa bin Anas said: “Allah made their wealth into engraved stones as it was before.”*21 About Allah’s statement, }and harden their hearts} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Harden their hearts means put a seal on them.”*3 ^uili iy-*3» |l * At-Jabaii 15:181. •2| At-Tabari 15:180. ' At-Tabari 15:181.

iso that they will not believe until they see the painful torment This prayer was from Musa because he was angry for the sake of Allah and His religion. He prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs when he was certain that there was no good in them. Similarly, NQh prayed and said: iMy Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers on the earth! If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants, and they will beget none but wicked disbelievers.} (71:26-27) HarQn said “Amin” to his brother’s prayer. And Allah answered Musa’s prayer. Allah said: iVerily, the invocation of you both is accepted.} “in destroying Fir'awn’s people. iVerily I have answered your prayers (both of you). So you both keep to the straight way} So as I have answered your prayer, you should remain steadfast on My command.’ Ibn Jurayj narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said about this Ayah: “Be steadfast and follow My command.” •”’ft K I* “M T?i Ji' i yj&JT % U i&i £ dzc xsM \% v %\ nr. ju 490. And We took the Children of Israel across the sea, and Fir'awn with his hosts followed them in oppression and enmity, till when drowning overtook him, he (Fira'wn) said: ",I believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the (i) Al-Tabari 15:187,

Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims.”} 191 . Now (you believe) while you refused to believe before and you were one of the mischief-makers.} 192. So this day We shall deliver your (dead) body (out from the sea) that you may be a sign to those who come after you! And verily, many among mankind are heedless ofOur Aydt.} The Children of Israel were saved and Fir'awn's People drowned Allah tells us how He caused Fir'awn and his soldiers to drown. The Children of Israel left Egypt in the company of Musa. It was said that there were six hundred thousand soldiers, plus offspring. They borrowed a lot of ornaments from the Copts and took that with them. Fir'awn became very angry with them. So he sent heralds to all the cities to send their soldiers. He embarked, following behind them, filled with great pride and with massive armies. Allah wanted this to happen for He had a plan for them. No one that had any authority or power remained behind in Fir'awn’s kingdom. They were all together and caught the Children of Israel at sunrise. iijsv^ ju gcyi iga} AAnd when the two hosts met each other, the companions of Musa said: "We are sure to be overtaken."} (26:61) They said that because when they got to the seashore Fir'awn was behind them. The two groups met face to face. The people with Musa kept asking, “How can we be saved today?” Musa replied, “I have been commanded to come this way.” MQsa said: 0it~- tp £>i '&} iNay, verily, with me is my Lord. He will guide me.} (26:62) It had been so difficult, but it suddenly became easy. Allah commanded him to strike the ocean with his staff. He did and the sea was cleft asunder, each part stood like a mighty mountain. The sea was split into twelve paths, each route for each Israelite tribe. Allah then commanded the wind and the path was dry for them.

1 4 4^* jii 4And strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken [by Fir'awn] nor being afraid (of drowning in the sea).>(20:77) The water in between the paths appeared as windows and

every tribe was able to see the other so they would not think that others were destroyed. The Children of Israel crossed the sea. When the last one crossed, Fir'awn and his soldiers had arrived at the edge of the other shore. They were one hundred thousand black horses in addition to horsemen of other colors. When Fir'awn saw the sea he was frightened. He wanted to turn back, but it was too late. Allah's decree prevailed and the prayer of Musa was answered. Jibril came on a war stallion. He passed by Fir'awn's horse. Jibril's horse whinnied at Fir'awn's and then Jibril rushed into the sea, and Fir'awn did the same behind him. Fir'awn no longer had any control over matters. He wanted to sound strong before his chiefs, so he said: "The Children of Israel do not have more right in the sea." So they rushed into the sea. Milkall was behind their army pushing them all to join. When they all were in the sea and the first of them was about to emerge on the other side, Allah, the All-Powerful, commanded the sea to strand them. The sea closed over them and none was saved. The waves took them up and down. The waves accumulated above Fir'awn and he was overwhelmed by the stupors of death. While in this state, he said: i# £ 3ZC 3\$ % 'A 'v J3 41 believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He (Allah) in Whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims He believed at a time when he couldn't benefit from his faith. & \$ % Ct tx 4dill!* jui-j 4 oii- Jti Jjf\ pill dii dt ijt> CJ pp-VI 4So when they saw Our punishment, they said : "We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him

as (His) partners." Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants. And there the disbelievers lost utterly (when Our torment covered them).>(40:84-85) Therefore Allah said, as a response to Fir'awn, Z&%^} iNow (you believe) while you refused to believe before?} do you say that just now when you have disobeyed Allah before that. 4And you were one of the mischief-makers.} You were among the makers of mischief on the earth who misled the people. iand We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day of Resurrection, they will not be helped.} (28:41) These facts about Fir'awn and his status at that time were among the secrets of the Unseen that Allah revealed to His Messenger, Muhammad Similarly Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that Allah's Messenger said; ji iiUJ jjZ'ji jfC.Jl JI>-^ i>-T Uj jfS : Jifar4 Jli' • it, • OjJb "fibril said to me, "If you could have seen me while I was taking black mud from the sea and placing into the mouth of Fir'awn out offear that the mercy would reach / iim ."n [1 Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Jarir12 * also recorded it. At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Gharib Sa/ uh."*3 About Allah's statement, kSjX* (jfi) 4So this day We shall deliver your (dead) body (out from the ** Musnad At-Tayalisi no. 341 121 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8:526. 131 At-Tabari 15:190-191.

654 Tafstr Ibn Kathir sea) that you may be a sign to those who come after you!} Ibn 'Abbas and others from among the Salaf have said: "Some of the Children of Israel doubted the death of Fir'awn so Allah commanded the sea to throw his body - whole, without a soul - with his known armor plate. The body was thrown to a high place on the land so that the Children of Israel could confirm his death and destruction." ' That is why Allah said, 4"So this day We shall deliver your.."} meaning that We will put your body on a high place on the earth. Mujahid said, i&H} iyour (dead) body} means, "your physical body. "2' 4**Mi <^J&} ithat you may be a sign to those who come after you!} meaning, so that might be a proof of your death and destruction for the Children of Israel. That also stood as a proof that Allah is All-Powerful, in Whose control are all the creatures. Nothing can bear His anger. Fir'awn and his people were destroyed on the day of 'Ashura', as recorded by Al-Bukhari, Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the

Prophet jH arrived at Al-Madinah, the Jews fasted the day of Ashurd'. So he asked, iJA U » «What is this day that you are fasting?» They responded This is the day in which MUsa was victorious over Fir'awn.' So the Prophet said, «Yom have more right to Musa than they, so fast if.*' 111 At-Tabari 15:196. At-Tabari 15:197. 131 Fath Al-B&ri 8 :198

V. | ffM fJA* liljj 493. And indeed We settled the Children of Israel in an honorable dwelling place, and provided them with good things, and they differed not until the knowledge came to them . Verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection in that in which they used to differ The Establishment of the Children of Israel in the Land and Their Provision from the Good Things In these Ayat, Allah tells us about all the worldly and religious gifts which He bestowed upon the Children of Israel. Allah's statement, honorable dwelling place means in Egypt and Syria, around Jerusalem, as it was said by some. When Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his soldiers, the Mosaic State took control of all of Egypt as Allah said: \y£=> Cj /iyj \$And We made the people who were considered weak to inherit the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed. And the fair Word of your Lord was fulfilled for the Children of Israel, because of their endurance. And We destroyed completely all the great works and buildings which Fir'awn and his people erected. 7:137) He said in other Ayat iSo, We expelled them from gardens and springs. Treasures, and every kind of honorable place. Thus, and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.M26-.57 -59) He also said:

iHow many of gardens and springs that they left behind...} (44 :25-27) They then continued with Musa, to seek Jerusalem - the land of Ibrahim, the friend of Allah. There were giant people in Jerusalem. The Children of Israel refrained from fighting them. So Allah expelled them into the wilderness for forty years. During this time in the wilderness, first Harun died and then Musa. Yusha' bin Nun led after them. Allah supported them to conquer Jerusalem and rule it for a period of time. His statement, y , at iand provided them with good things means from the lawful, pure and useful provision that is good in nature and in Law. Then Allah said: iand they differed not until the knowledge came to them.} There should be no reason for them to have any disputes among them since Allah has sent them knowledge and explained different matters and issues to them. It has been mentioned in a Hadith, 'a\\ jlj jt ^>-1 jji • ^', » | ar* •• , j» * , ' , I ' mS(I • ' ' SS * • * 1 / ' iji U^t l **ji jTer'J T'*' or* OrfrO fl i til I j O 9 jtwl 9 i vThe Jews separated into seventy-one sects, and the Christians separated into seventy-two sects, and this Ummah will separate into seventy-three sects, one of which is in Paradise, seventy- two in the Fire .» They asked, “Who are they O Messenger of Allah!?” He replied; f iThose upon what I and my Companions are upon .» It was recorded by Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak with this wording.' 11 So here Allah said, 111 Al-Hakim 1:129.

4pr*> iVerily your Lord will judge between them Here the meaning is, to distinguish between them {the Day of Resurrection in that which they used to differ.} juJ u&j ot C.Z.^=0' Ojlju -idt tL2 ijLi i)f} «L\ oijL lyjT V> Oi ^ ^-5 oi *3*J' jj> ^ pjfe **»• •C^J' Si oi 15 £.# Jfc- 494. So i/ you are in doubt concerning that which We foretold revealed unto you, then ask those who are reading the Book before you. Verily, the truth has come to you from your Lord. So be not of those who doubt (it).} 495. And be not one of those who belie the Ayat of Allah, for then you shall be one of the losers.} 496. Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe.} 497. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} Previous books Attest to the Truth of the

Qur'an Allah said: 4^pj ikffi 4 (**•*£ \fj& fJOjMi (jiif -C^jrVf Jj-J' {Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom they find written of with them in the Tawrdh and the Injtl.}(7:157) They are as certain of this as they are about who their children are, yet they hide it and distort it. They did not believe in it despite its clear evidence. Therefore Allah said: •JJlf

{Truly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} meaning they would not believe in a way that they might benefit from that belief. This is when they believe at a time one may not be able to benefit from his belief. An example is when MQsa prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs, saying: J4& \$ jJ* e> !w & ifjVf 36\$ {Our Lord! Destroy their wealth, and harden their hearts, so that they will not believe until they see the painful tortnent.}[10:88) And Allah said: \$Ml j;j\A-ftl >A'Ss'i'" faji 'X > " £& 'XZ-n&'g& ££.; ^ j# u\$0 j)> ,&u-i &s;^ tts j 't {And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they would not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most of them behave ignorantly.} (6:111) Allah then said:

Suraih 10. Yunus (98) (Part-11) 659 498. Was there any town (community) that believed (after seeing the punishment), and its faith (at that moment) saved it (from the punishment)?- except the people ofYunus; when they believed, We removedfrom them the torment of disgrace in the life of the (present) world, and permitted them to enjoy for a while}. Belief at the Time of Punishment did not help except with the People ofYunus Allah asked, 'did any town from the previous nations, believe in its entirety when they received the Messengers? All of the Messengers thatWe sent before you, O Muhammad, were denied by their people or the majority oftheir people.' Allah said, 'ii ')\$ "^1 l* J® iAlas for mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him>(36:30) ^ J Jrv oj (•**!» cs, uS C jSfS} iLikewise, no Messenger came to those before them but they said: "A sorcerer or a madman!")}(51:52) and tyj\$ if Eifcll 'J) J! jii 4 Jt 0-!\$ £• 4And similarly, We sent not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeedfollow theirfootsteps."}{43:23) As found in the authentic Hadith, ** * j >/ Aha iThe Prophets were displayed before me. There was a Prophet who passed with a group of people, and a Prophet who passed with only one man, a Prophet with two men, and a Prophet

660 Tafstr Ibn Kathir with no one.t'11 Then he mentioned the mulititude of followers that Musa had, peace be upon him, then that he saw his nation of people filling from the west to the east. The point is that between MQsa and Yunus, there was no nation, in its entirety, that believed except the people of Yunus, the people of Naynawa (Nineveh). And they only believed because they feared that the torment from which their Messenger warned them, might strike them. They actually witnessed its signs. So they cried to Allah and asked for help. They engaged in humility in invoking Him. They brought their children and cattle and asked Allah to lift the torment from which their Prophet had warned them. As a result, Allah sent His mercy and removed the scourge from them and gave them respite. Allah said: oft&if 4 ^ 'oj jsj \$ 4Except the people of Yunus; when they believed, We removed from them the torment of disgrace in the life of the world, and permitted them to enjoyfor a while.} In interpreting this Ayah, Qatadah said: "No town has denied the truth and then believed when they saw the scourge, and then their belief benefited them, with the exception of the people of Yunus. When they lost their Prophet

and they thought that the scourge was close upon them, Allah sent through their hearts the desire to repent. So they wore woolen fabrics and they separated each animal from its offspring. They then cried out to Allah for forty nights. When Allah saw the truth in their hearts and that they were sincere in their repentance and regrets, He removed the scourge from them.” Qatadah said: “It was mentioned that the people of Yunus were in Naynawa, the land of Mosul.”,2) This was also reported from Ibn Mas*ud, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and others from the Salaf.*3’ if- J-tli cAil CLf- cgyVi 4 f cfy icj ai 111 Fath Al-Bari 10:224. At-Tabari 15:207. At-Tabari 15:208-210.

* OX•^j^i 499. And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. So, will you then compel mankind, until they become believers.} 4100. It is notfor any person to believe, except by the leave of Allah, and He will put the Rijs on those who do not reason.} It is not Part ofAllah’s Decree to compel Belief Allah said: 4\$} :tt. yf} 4And had your Lord willed} meaning ‘O Muhammad, if it had been the will ofyour Lord, He would make all the people of the earth believe in what you have brought to them. But Allah has wisdom in what He does.’ Similarly, Allah said: viU’-ib tICj ‘Jj •If.‘j iil O&j jG. j)j} iLst*^&& ^ 4And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree. Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (His saying) "Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."} (11:118-119) He also said, 4^?‘\$’ u‘CJ’ »Ll4 jj jt j-tjt pi\} 4Have not then those who believed yet known that had Allah willed, He could have guided all mankind?} (13:31) Therefore, Allah said: 4S-& \p> Sti} 4So, will you then compel mankind} and force them to believe.

iupoti those who do not reason meaning, Allah’s proofs and evidences, and He is the Just in all matters, guiding whom He wills to guide, and leadingwhom He wills astray. J3 fvojy; g c; ^ lit; £} ^ pz jl SB# £ ‘-HU « !> .61 jL ^ -£S & iujiT j£c -rjtj 44 4102. Say: "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth." But neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who do not believe.} 4102. Then do they wait save for the likes of the days of men who passed away before them? Say: 'Waif then, I am waiting with you among those who wait.}" 4103. Then We save Our Messengers and those who believe! Thus it is incumbent upon Us to save the believers.} The Command to reflect upon the Creation of the Heavens and the Earth Allah, the Exalted, guides His servants to reflect upon His blessings. What Allah has created in the heavens and the earth is part of the clear signs for those who possess correct understanding. From that which is in the heavens are the luminous stars, the firmaments, the moving planetary bodies, the sun and the moon. This also includes the night and day, their alternating, and their merging so that one is long and the other is short. Then they alternate (through the year) so that the long one becomes short and the short one becomes long. Likewise, from the signs in the heavens is the rising of the sun, its vastness, its beauty and its adornment. Also, whatever rain that Allah sends down from the heavens, thereby bringing the earth to life after its death, and causing various types of fruits, crops, flowers and plants to grow, is from its signs. Whatever Allah creates in the earth from the various species of beasts, with their differing colors and benefits (for man), are signs. The mountains, plains, deserts, civilizations, structures and barren lands of the earth are signs. Then there are the wonders of the sea and its waves. Yet, it still has been made subservient and submissive to those who travel upon its surface. It carries their ships, allowing them to traverse upon

665 Surah 10. Yunus (105 - 707) (Part-11 6* ^ TT\ ^ ^T<*5 *0) I *iL'.. o\^j ^ K * >T /' ^ > >5 // <•>
 idJLd&<^2 L^J44Maj3j;^b_j£ jLJ^ j^aU^tqfojs0 it SM» ^ iYour Lord has written - —^^ , < ^ >:
 •<,,>' /-£v'-i*^2coC1^iJj>O^S '£>^i»i<-SiiX prl^' Jj,\$2*1" (prescribed) mercy for Himself) [6:54]
 i£j^oi ^Ult £fe \$) * >*•' / ,?f «M»f •>/' oJxjj jull juti 56 ^ tij' lat JlxS Cr^J Cyi^ « #' ii ^ £& ^ cfc
 ^05i.Jii(dt£^ X> U_i»- <^jll i>ji m fyS "ij dfc -iS^a> Vj tiLij V U 41>l ' , \ s& £ >> Ici 4 im ^)j j* *1
 taJ 4^} % * A*> Jh. Jf) 'tiK6 oi »LJ {j* .4 4104. Say:"0 peupit: ij you are in doubt about my religion - I
 will never worship those whom you worship besides Allah, rather, I will worship Alldl, the One Who
 cause you to die. And I was commanded to be one of the believers.) 4105. And (I was commanded),
 ",Direct your face toward the Hanif(monotheism) religion, and not be one of the idolaters.") 4106. "And
 do not invoke besides Allah what will not benefit you nor harm you. For if you did, you would certainly
 be one of the wrongdoers ") 4107. And if Allah touches you with harm, there is none who can lift it but
 He. And if He intends good for you, then none can repel His favor which He causes to reach whom He
 wills among His servants. And He is the Pardoning, the Merciful.)

harm only come from Allah alone and no one shares with His power over these things. Therefore, He is
 the One Who deserves to be worshipped alone, without ascription of partners. Concerning His
 statement, iAndHe is the Pardoning, the Merciful . This means that He is forgiving and merciful
 towards those who turn to Him in repentance, regardless of what sin the person has committed. Even if
 the person associated a partner with Allah, verily Allah would forgive him if he repented from i <s£r.
 Q} itxJS \$} •4*- 410S. Say: "O people! Now the truth has come to you from your Lord. So whoever
 receives guidance, he does so far the good of himself. And whoever goes astray, he does so at his own
 loss. And I am not set over you as a guardian.} il09. And follow what is revealed to you, and be patient
 until Allah gives judgment. And He is the best of the judges .} Allah, the Exalted, commands His
 Messenger jgg to inform the people that that which he has brought them from Allah is the truth. It is a
 message concerning which there is no doubt or suspicion. Therefore, whoever is guided by it and
 follows it, then he only benefits himself by doing so. Likewise, whoever is misguided away from this
 message, then he will suffer the consequences against his own self. iAnd I am not set over you as a
 guardian} This means, *1 am not a guardian over you in order for you to become believers. I am only a
 wamer to you and guidance belongs to Allah, the Exalted.' Concerning Allah's statement. ijij jut c g%}

^And follow what has been revealed to you, and be patient^ This means, 'Adhere to that which Allah
 has revealed to you, and inspired you with, and be patient with the opposition that you meet from the
 people.' iuntil Allah gives judgment This means, "Until Allah judges between you and them.' iAnd He
 is the best of judges. > This means that He is the best of those who pass judgment, due to His Justice and
 His wisdom. This is the End of Volume Four. m' Volume Five begins with Surah Hud

Surah 11: Hud

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2557]

Opening The TafslrofSurahHud (Chapter - 11)

Which was Revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2557–2569]

SurahHudmade the Prophet's Hair turn Gray Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that Abu Bakr said, "O Messenger of Allah, verily your hair has turned gray." The Prophet jg replied, «Surahs Hud, Al-Waqi'ah, Al-Mursaltd, 'Ammā Yatasa'lun [An-Nab'd'] and Idhash-Shamsu Kuzvwirat [At-Takwir] have turned my hair gray.® In another narration he jg said, tSiirah Hud and its sisters.. In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. iS j3 Ji fti S&& f Jt*%p &&4& ? % &%A? \ \$-4 P- P&^ *3\$ sj\$ \$2 4* 'S'i W4SI 41. AlifLam Ra. (This is) a Book, the Aydt whereof are perfect (in every sphere of knowledge), and then explained in detail from One (Allah), Who is All-Wise Well-Acquainted (with all things). TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi, 9 :184

18 TafsTr Ibtt Kathtr 42. (Saying worship none but Allah. Verily, I (Muhammad) am unto you from Him a wamer and a bringer of glad tidings.) 43 . And (commanding you): "Seek the forgive- ness of your Lord, and turn to Him in repen- tance, thatHe may grant yougoodenjoyment,fora term appointed, and be- stow His aboundinggrace to every owner of grace. But if you turn away, then I fear for you the tormentofaGreatDay . 44. To Allah is your return, and He is able to do all things."} The Qur'an and its Call to (worship) Allah Alone A discussion concerning the letters of the alphabet (which appear at the beginning of some chapters of the Qur'an) has already preceded at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. That discussion is sufficient without any need for repetition here. Concerning Allah's statement, iThe Ayat whereofare perfect and then explained in detail} This means perfect in its wording, detailed in its meaning. Thus, it is complete in its form and its meaning. This interpretation was reported from Mujahid and Qatadah, and Ibn Jarir [At-Tabari] preferred it. r tn mm*1 \a I.«L m \$km, ' CJt At-Tabari 15:227.

Concerning the meaning of Allah's statement. ifrom One (Allah), Who is All-Wise, Well-Acquainted This means that it (the Qur'an) is from Allah, Who is Most Wise in His statements and His Laws, and Most Aware of the final outcome of matters. \ ^ i(Saying) worship none but Allah .} This means that this Qur'an descended, perfect and detailed, with the purpose of Allah's worship alone, without any partners. This is similar to the statement of Allah, the Exalted, v)%V %4 A \il t *1 iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying): There is no God but I, so worship Me.}

[21:25) It is similar to Allah's statement, ^OjiAlt it 4 CJL Ijj} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): 'Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Taghiit (callingfalse deities./ >[16:36] In reference to Allah's statement, iVerily, I am unto you from Him a wamer and a bringer of glad tidings.) This means, "Verily, I am unto you a warner of the punishment if you oppose Him (Allah), and a bringer of the good news of reward ifyou obey Him." This meaning has been recorded in the authentic Hadith which states that the Messenger of Allah jjg ascended mount As-Safa and called out to his near relatives of the Quraysh tribe. When they gathered around him, he said, M \$ £Yj\ ! U-ij* - *0 people of Quraysh, if I informed you that a cavalry was

20 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr going to attack you in the morning, would you not believe me?» They replied, "We have not found you to be a liar." He £f| said, iVerily I am a wamer unto you before a severe punishment .n11 Concerning His statement, ^^ dl ££4 # y 4And (commanding you) : 'Seek the forgiveness of your Lord, and turn to Him in repentance, that He may grant you good enjoyment, for a term appointed, and bestow His abounding grace to every owner ofgrace. This means, "I am commanding you to seek forgiveness from previous sins and to turn to Allah from future sins, and thereafter you abide by that." 4that He may grant you good enjoyment, This is in reference to this worldly life. 4for a term appointed, and bestow His abounding grace to every owner ofgraced This refers to the Hereafter, according to QatadahJ21 "This is like the statement of Allah, ^Whoever works righteousness - whether male orfemale - while a true believer, verily to him We will give a good life. \$[16:97] Concerning Allah's statement, 4jg fk 'iy ' Dala'il An-Nubuwwah, 2 :181 , similar wording with Al-Bukhari no. 4971 , and Muslim no. 208. At-Tabari 15:231.

iBut if you turn away, then I fear for you the torment of a Great Day.) This is a severe threat for whoever turns away from the commandments of Allah, the Exalted, and rejects His Messengers. Verily, the punishment will afflict such a person on the Day of Resurrection and there will be no escape from it. }To Allah is your return,} This is means your return on the Day of Judgement. &\$&£ iand He is able to do all things.) This means that He is capable of doing whatever He wishes, whether it be goodness towards His Awliya' (friends and allies), or vengeance upon His enemies. This also includes His ability to repeat the creation of His creatures on the Day of Resurrection. This section encourages fear, just as the previous section encourages hope. G <3*54 cp Spz ow -31p AWi pi oil 'jji }5- No doubt! They did fold up their breasts, that they may hide from Him. Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments. He knows what they conceal and what they reveal. Verily, He is the All-Knower of the (innermost secrets) of the breasts .} Allah isAware ofAll Things Ibn 'Abbas said, "They used to dislike facing the sky with their private parts, particularly during sexual relations. Therefore, Allah revealed this verse." Al-Bukhari recorded by way of Ibn Jurayj, who reported from Muhammad bin 'Abbad bin Jafar who said, "Ibn 'Abbas recited, ii vb "Behold their breasts did fold up." So I said: 'O Abu Al-'Abbas! What does -their breasts did fold

up- mean?' He said, "The man used to have sex with his woman, but he would be shy, or he used to have answering the call of nature (in an open space) but, he would be shy. Therefore, this verse, 4No doubt! They didfold up their breasts,} was revealed."111 In another wording of this narration, Ibn 'Abbas said, "There were people who used to be shy to remove their clothes while answering the call of nature in an open space and thus be naked exposed to the sky. They were also ashamed of having sexual

relations with their women due to fear of being exposed towards the sky. Thus, this was revealed concerning them.” Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that {they cover themselves} means that they cover then- heads.¹³¹ 46. And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} Allah is Responsible for the Provisions of All Creatures Allah, the Exalted, informs that He is responsible for the provisions of all the creatures that dwell in the earth, whether they are small, large, sea-dwelling or land-dwelling. He knows their place of dwelling and their place of deposit. This means that He knows where their journeying will end in the earth and where they will seek shelter when they wish to nest. This place of nesting is also considered their place of deposit. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah and others reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said concerning the statement, 111 Fath Al-Bdri 8 :200 121 Ibid. 131 Ibid.

{And He knows its dwelling place} that it means where it resides. In reference to the statement, {and its deposit.} he (Ibn ‘Abbas) said it means where it will die. Allah informs us that all of this is written in a Book with Allah that explains it in detail. This is similar to Allah’s statement. Vj j 0> Cj} i {There is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are communities like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered.} [6:38], and 65 ^ V *3&£ Y^} 40jS? 4% off.% yij 4#’&& 4 % l+lii VI i {And with Him are the keys of the Ghayb (all that is hidden and unseen), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is in the land and in the sea ; not a leaf falls, but he knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} [6:59] Cjfc’s’j ii—’ 4 j>i. 4jJI ft.j} ii & bt ^oft. Vt kL£ C y/iZ& 4 OKK gX V[tfc 47. And He it is Who has created the heavens and the earth in six Days and His Throne was over the water, that He might try you, which of you is the best in deeds. But if you were to say m At-Tabari 15:241.

to them: "You shall indeed be raised up after death," those who disbelieve would be sure to say, "This is nothing but obvious magic."> 48. And if We delay the torment for them till a detennined Ummah (term), they are sure to say, “What keeps it back?” Verily, on the day it reaches them, nothing will turn it away from them, and they will be surrounded by (or fall in) that at which they used to mockfy Allah created the Heavens and the Barth in Six Days Allah, the Exalted, informs of His power over all things, and that He created the heavens and the earth in six days. He mentions that His Throne was over the water before that, just as Imam Ahmad recorded that Imran bin Husayn said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said, «Accept the glad tidings, O tribe of Tamtm/» They said. Verily you have brought us glad tidings and you have given us.’ Then he Sg said. «Accept the glad tidings, O people of Yemen ! They said, “We accept. Therefore, inform us about the beginning of this matter and how it was.’ He said. % J C-Sj ..dl Js ^ js jp iii jb oAllah was before everything and His Throne was over the water. He then wrote in the Preserved Tablet mentioning everything .s Then a man came to me and said, “O Imran, your she camel has escaped from her fetter.” I then went out after her and I do not know what was said after I left.” This Hadlth has been recorded in the Two Sahihs of Al- m Ahmad 4 :43 1

25Surali 11. Hud (7-8) (Part-12) Bukhari and Muslim with a variety of wordings.’ In SahVi Muslim, it is recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin A1-‘As said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, Alw. . i! i 4&1 jl» ;dl “Verily Allah measured the amount of sustenance of the creatures fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth, and His Throne was over the water . »'2 ' Under the explanation of

this (resurrection of the dead) because he is bewitched, and he wants you to follow him in what his bewitchment tells him. Concerning Allah's statement, 3.1 yZR £1 4And ifWe delay the tormentfar them till a determined term,} Allah, the Exalted, is saying "If We delay the torment and the destruction of these polytheists until cm appointed time and a period determined, and We promise them a specific time period (of life), they would still say, in rejection and haste; iWhat keeps it back?} They mean by this, "What delays this torment from overtaking us?" Both rejection and doubt are their very nature. Therefore, they have no escape or refuge from the torment. The Meanings oftheWord Ummah The word Ummah is used in the Qur'an and Sunnah with a number of different meanings. Sometimes when it is used it means a specified period of time. An example is the statement of Allah, the Exalted, in this verse, ijijxZ > 3,1 d\} itill a determined Ummah (term),} This is also the meaning in the statement of Allah in Surah YQsuf, z'M C& a iThen the man who was released, now after Ummah (some time) remembered.} (12:45]

Surah U . Hud (7-8) (Part-12) 29 The word Ummah is also used to refer to the Imam (leader) who is followed. An example of this is in the statement of Allah, ot\$ A> bff- A 4Verily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, obedient to Allah, Hanif, and he was not of those who were polytheists.} [16:120] The word Ummah is also used to mean religion and religious creed. This is as Allah mentions concerning the polytheists, that they said, '<£ l)6 Eitl; liJUj iVerily, we found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeedfollow theirfootsteps.} [43:23] The word Ummah is also used to mean a group (of people). This is as Allah says, UT;£SI' UJj^ 4And when he arrived at the water (well) ofMadyan, hefound there a group ofmen watering (theirflocks) . [28:23] Allah also said, & !4£i #5d sk=, 4 gi;Q} 4And verily. We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit."} (16:36) Allah also said, 4And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes, the matter will be judged between them with justice, and they will not be wronged.} [10:47]

The meaning of Ummah here is those people who have had a

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Messenger sent among them. The meaning of Ummah in this context includes the believers and the disbelievers among them. This is like what has been recorded in Sahih Muslim, «3&l irS N p£0^ 'ij 4*4: i#» ^^ c»i

&*.i& ttt tg&iiViP % He in Whose Hand * my"£ *" is T"" '""*^ > »> ' one 0/ fftis Ummah, whether he be a Jew or \ ^ \s_ " '-"-U Christian, who hears of ^ me and does not believe vOjJjy^CfjCX\ in me, except that he '. Av-V-" "u "f wi// enter the Hell- V^cyJ'oVJoP'^criv^ycJ^l yjre n(l) In reference to the W. > .<.,4 Ummah of followers, v— sijXju*sU\ then they are those Q&j&4}&rrj3»Z(&i£Z. "ho believe ln *1» >!,. r r,-.<.-<- C", , . v Messengers, as Allah said, j&iJUiaiiSSciSOsta-j^ d % & 1 *Yom (the followers of <, .t, - ^ ",.1. ProPhet Muhammad) are — Cp^^/r-'j the best Ummah ever hi ij raised up for mankind.) Prophet si said, «77ien / will say, "My Ummah (followers), my Ummah!" The word Ummah is also used to mean a sect or party. An example of this usage is in the statement of Allah, £1 A&£ iAnd of the people ofMusa there is an Ummah who lead (the men) with truth and established justice therewith .) [7:159] Likewise is His statement, it\$A^0 ff\ rf) ^ Muslim 1 :134. Muslim 1:183.

31 Surah 11. Hud (9-11) (Part-12) 4A party of the People of the Scripture stand for the right.} [3 :113] >ry.t • y "\ > r • ' • ' - ' ^oOj * I4I2*/ (w» L> { '/' " Af #>< <* Vi *u c*^ > iif il i.l >*<{-' jx * ' ' ?/•" !>A<o QliLmJI yAA AL—j -Lju tluu 4 *>4" >4^ C .'^halt ijLij 49. And ifWe gme man a taste 0/ mercy /rom Us, and then withdraw itfrom him, verily, he is despairing, ungrateful.} 410. But ifWe let him tastegood (favor) after evil (poverty and harm) has touched him, he is sure to say: "Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is exultant and boastful (ungrateful to Allah).} ill. Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds: those, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward (Paradise).} The changing of Man's Attitude in Happiness and Hardship Allah, the Exalted, informs about mankind and the blameworthy characteristics that he possesses, except for those believing servants upon whom Allah has bestowed His mercy. Allah explains that when any hardship befalls man, after he has experienced blessings, he is disheartened and he despairs of any good in the future. He denies and rejects (the bounties of) his previous condition. Thus, he behaves as if he has never seen any good and he loses all hope for relief (from his situation). Likewise, if any blessing befalls him after displeasure, ix£ 3J& } ihe is sure to say, "Ills have departedfrom me."} This means that he will claim that no harm or calamity will afflict him after this (blessing). i'f*\$ 'Aft iSurely, he is exultant and boastfid (ungratefid to Allah).} This means that he is pleased with what he has in his hand and ungrateful (to Allah). At the same time he is boastful

towards others. Allah, the Exalted, then says, 4Except those ivho shoio patience^ meaning, those who show patience during times of hardship and adversity. In reference to Allah's statement, iand do righteous good deeds This means that they perform the good deeds in times of ease and good health. Concerning the statement, ithose, theirs will be forgiveness) meaning, that they will be forgiven due to the calamities that afflicted them. Concerning Allah's statement, iand a great reward.) This great reward is due to them because of what they sent forth (of good deeds) in their times of ease. This is similar to what is mentioned in the Hadith, V; ij 4jJ ij p % ppji i !;J1 •oUlki {jA If; CP iil I NJ 1^5liJ ijp- «Bt/ He in Whose Hand is my soul! No worry, calamity, distress, illness, or grief strikes a believer, even the prick of a thorn, except tlwt Allah will expiate his sins for him because of In the Sahih it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, hp il i yf. oil 'j) iuS ji'fLjj i !;ju ^\jt jj- p-S/ kllii ir~^j 'd Ijp 015 pi* *P» oLil jjj i*J lp». pii *0^1 m Ahmad 3 :4.

33 Surah 11. Hud (12-14) (Part-12) iBy He in Whose Hand is my soul! Allah does not decree any matter for the believer except tluit it is good for him . If any blessing befalls him, he is thankful (to Allah) and that is good for him. If any harm comes to him, he is patient and that is also good for him. This is (a bounty) exclusively for the believer, n111 For this reason, Allah, the Exalted, says, I.; 'il,'ill i 'tl . <> —'"if" ul -) s^^)} 4 - T 4By Al-'Asr (the time). Verily, man is in loss. Except those ivho believe and do righteous good deeds. And recommend one another to the truth and recommend one another to patience .} [103:1-3] Allah also says, 4 Verily 412. So perchance you may give up a part of what is revealed unto you, and that your breast feels straitened for it because they say, "Why has not a treasure been sent doion unto him, or an angel come with him?" But you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Guardian over all things.} 413. Or they say, "He forged it." Say: "Bring you then ten forged Surahs like unto it, and call whomsoever you can, other than Allah, ifyou speak the truth!"} 414. If then they answer you not, know then that it is sent down with the knowledge of Allah and that there is no god 111 MusUm 4:2295.

34 Tafstr Ibn Kathir besides Him! Will you then be Muslims The Messenger sgr grieving by the Statements of the Polytheists, and His Gratification This statement of Allah, the Exalted, to His Messenger jg comforted the worries that the polytheists were causing him due to their statements directed towards him. This is just as Allah says about them. ^ j\y*}\ ui» ac gJc IX % ') bx,4 \$2 jl iAnd they say: "Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?" Or; "(why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?" And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched [25:7-8] Thus, Allah commanded His Messenger and guided him to not let these statements of theirs grieve his heart. Allah directed him sg; to not let these statements prevent him, or deter him from calling them to Allah, both day and night. This is as Allah said, C ty-Jl^ ilIndeed. We know that your breast is straitened at what they say> [15:97] Allah says in this verse, iSo perchance you may give up a part ofwhat is revealed unto you, and that your breast feels straitened for it because they say...) The meaning here is that he (the Prophet jgj) may be compelled to give up the Message due to what they (the polytheists) say about him. However, Allah goes on to explain: "You (Muhammad) are only a wamer and you have an example in your brothers of the Messengers who came before you. For

35Surah 11. Hud (15-16) (Part-12) verily, the previous Messengers were rejected and harmed, yet they were patient until the help ofAllah came to them." An Explanation concerning the Miracle ofthe Qur'an Then Allah, the Exalted, explains the miracle of the Qur'an, and that no one is able to produce its like, or even bring ten chapters, or one chapter like it. The reason for this is that the Speech of the Lord of all that exists is not like the speech of the created beings, just as His attributes are not like the attributes of the creation. Nothing resembles His existence. Exalted is He, the Most Holy, and the Sublime. There is no deity worthy of worship except He and there is no true Lord other than He. Then Allah goes on to say, ilf then they answer you not,} Meaning, that if they do not come with a reply to that which you have challenged them with (to the reproduction of ten chapters like the Qur'an), then know that it is due to their inability to do so. Know (that this is a proof) that this is the speech revealed from Allah. It contains His knowledge, His commands and His prohibitions. Then Allah continues by saying, *21# 3^1 iand that there is no God besides Him! Will you then be Muslims?} m&z eft of^ 415. Wlwsoever desires the life of the world and its glitter, to them We shall pay in full (the wages of) their deeds therein, and they wilt have no diminution therein .} 416. They are those for whom there is nothing in the Hereafter but Fire, and VAin are , thendeeds they did therein. And of no effect is that which they used to do.} ...

Whoever wants the Worldly Life, then He will have no Share ofthe Hereafter Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning this verse, "Verily those who show off, will be given their reward for their good deeds in this life. This will be so that they are not wronged, even the amount equivalent to the size of the speck on a date-stone." Ibn ‘Abbas continued saying, "Therefore, whoever does a good deed seeking to acquire worldly gain - like fasting, prayer, or standing for prayer at night - and he does so in order to acquire worldly benefit, then Allah says, ‘Give him the reward of that which he sought in the worldly life,’ and his deed that he did is wasted because he was only seeking the life of this world. In the Hereafter he will be of the losers." A similar narration has been reported from Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and many others. Anas bin Malik and Al-Hasan both said, "This verse was revealed concerning the Jews and the Christians. t3* Mujahid and others said, "This verse was revealed concerning the people

who perform deeds to be seen.”¹⁴ Qatadah said, “Whoever’s concern, intention and goal is this worldly life, then Allah will reward him for his good deeds in this life. Then, when reaches the next life, he will not have any good deeds that will be rewarded. However, concerning the believer, he will be rewarded for his good deeds in this life and in the Hereafter as well.”¹⁵¹ Allah, the Exalted, says, *لَا يَفْضُلُ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ عَلَى الْغَائِبِينَ* ‘A U** ^ jLif AiXj J? Cj 0* Hj&j JuS 'XA -i %j yijJ ijipij Jau Jp L i3i* AAS ^Whoever desires the quick-passing (transitory enjoyment of this 111 At-Tabari 15:263. 121 At-Tabari 15:264, 265. At-Tabari 15:265. At-Tabari 15:266. |s| At-Tabari 15:264.

37 Surah 11. Hud (17) (Part-12) world), We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have ap- pointed for him Hell; he will burn therein dis- graced and rejected. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer - then such are the ones whose striv- ing shall be appreciated. On each - these as well as those - We bestow from the bounties of your Lord. And the bounties of your Lord can never be forbidden. See how We prefer one above an- other, and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in intricacy.} [17:18-21] rrr •sgyjssa -"V ^ y' AJj s_jky<a_>j^ dl JWISjL^y Allah, the Exalted, says. £j% - #» C#’ /i? /’ k»*/ . ^ . Stt ^y *** 4 \$ ^Mfaosoeuer desires the reward of the Hereafter, We giue him increase in his reward, and whosoever desires the reward of this world, We give him thereof, and he has no portion in the Hereafter.} [42:20] iL»yj l£fy j£ji 4-^T yj? Crt> o; *4 jltf! 4^ ^ t^zy j; -it 3jt*Jd vitjljl 417. Gm they who rely on a clear proof from their Lord, and

38 Tafslr Ibn Kathir whom a witness from Him recites (follows) it; and before it, came the Book of Musa, a guidance and a mercy, they believe therein, but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place. So be not in doubt about it. Verily, it is the truth from your Lord, but most of mankind believe not.} The One Who believes in the Qur’an is upon Clear Proof from His Lord Allah, the Exalted, informs of the condition of the believers who are upon the natural religion of Allah, which He made inherent in His creatures. This is based upon their confession to Him that there is none worthy of worship except He. This is similar to Allah’s statement, *يُحِبُّكَ* iSo set you your face towards the religion, Hantfan. Allah's Fitrah with which He has created mankind.}^ [30:30], In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *يُحِبُّكَ* VS <Jl— j\ ^j\j.W’i jt 1 jJji 3fy *Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, but his parents make him a Jew, Christian, or Magian. This is just as the calf that is bom whole. Have you noticed any calves that are bom mutilated?>|2) In Sahih Muslim it is recorded that lyad bin Himar said that the Messenger of Allah said, *يُحِبُّكَ* If- cJl>- :J)Vj iil «Allah, the Exalted, says, ‘Verily, I created my servants Hunafti’ , but the devils came to them and distracted them from

The meaning of this Ayah is, “Dedicate yourself to the natural

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religion of Allah which He made for humanity.” Fath Al-Bari 3 :290 , and Muslim 4 :2047

39 Surah 11. Hud (17) (Part-12 their religion . They made unlawful for them what 1 had made lawful for them and they commanded them to associate partners with Me, concerning which no authority has been revealed . » 11 Therefore, the believer is one who remains upon this Fitrah. Concerning Allah’s

statement, 4^ >,&} iand whom a witnessfrom Him recites (follows) it;} This means that a witness comes to him from Allah. That witness is the pure, perfect and magnificent legislation that Allah revealed to the Prophets. These legislations were finalized with the legislation (Shari'ah) of Muhammad s§. The believer has the natural disposition that bears witness to (the truth of) the general legislation, and accepts that specific laws are taken from the general legislation. The Fitrah accepts the Shari'ah and believes in it. For this reason Allah, the Exalted, says. <i%U& m 4Can they who rely on a clear proof from their Lord, and whom a witness from Him recites (follows) it;} This clear proof which is recited is the Qur'an, which Jibril conveyed to the Prophet H and the Prophet Muhammad conveyed it to his Ummah. Then Allah says, 4&J- <& &>} 4and before it, came the Book of Musa,} This means that before the Qur'an, there was the Book of Musa, the Tawrah. tq} 4a guidance and a mercy} This means that Allah, the Exalted, revealed it to that Ummah as a leader for them and a guide for them to follow, as a mercy from Allah upon them. Therefore, whoever believed in it with true faith, then it would lead him to believe in the Qur'an as well. For this reason Allah said, 4'?> m Muslim 4:2197.

ithey believe therein Then Allah, the Exalted, threatens those who reject the Qur'an, or any part of it, by saying, oi ibid those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place. This is directed towards everyone on the face of the earth who disbelieves in the Qur'an, whether they are idolators, disbelievers, People of the Scripture, or other sects from the descendants of Adam. This applies to all whom the Qur'an reaches, regardless of their differences in color, appearance, or nationality. As Allah says, ithat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} [6:19] Allah, the Exalted, said, iiZJ: 4l sj-ut <&> iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah."} Allah says, i'tMy 'ey 'j£>o <yj} ibid those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.} In SahXh Muslim it is recorded that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said, 1-jfa -iSiyU i'jt ^ A> jt "By He in Whose Hand is my soul! there is no one of this Ummah, whether he be a Jew or Christian, who hears of me and does not believe in me, except that he will enter the Hell- fire. »[11 |i| Muslim 1 :135.

41Surah 11. Hud (17) (Part-12) Every Hadith is confirmed by the Qur'an Ayyub As-Sakhtiyani reported from Said bin Jubayr that he said, "I did not hear any Hadith of the Prophet substantiated as he stated it, except that I found its confirmation in the Qur'an. (The narrator said, "Or he said, 1 found its verification in the Qur'an."") Thus, it reached me that

the Prophet said, & 'n * 1' SJ cJi * ^ j lb «There is no one of this Ummah, whether he be a Jew or Christian, who hears of me and does not believe in me, except that he will enter the Hellfire. Therefore, I said, Where is its verification in the Book of Allah? Most of what I have heard reported from the Messenger of Allah I have found its verification in the Qur'an.' Then I found this verse, ^ 'j&k fix} ibut those of the sects that reject it (the Qur'an), the Fire will be their promised meeting place. And this means from all religions." Then Allah says, iSo be not in doubt about it. Verily, it is the truth from your Lord,} This means that the Qur'an is the truth from Allah and there is no doubt or suspicion concerning it. This is as Allah says. 4Alif Lam Mim . The revelations of the Book in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists!}[32:1-2\ Allah, the Exalted, says, 4*j bf,t m At-Tabari 15:280.

iAlifLam Mim. Tins is the Book in which there is no doubt.} [2 : 1-2] The Ayah; ibut most of mankind believe not.} is similar to Allah's statement, \ij} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you

desire it eagerly.}[12:103] Likewise, Allah says, 4A frfr" o6 V-j« i.g\$' - j <>• Flu\$} iAnd ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far awayfrom Allah's path.} Allah also says, % IV VI^ indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them : and theyfollowed him, all except a group of true believers.^[34:20] ^4\$ 5fl 35} frAA oj-L-m Je «ii *Li) yt j-Ej jc OIT Uj cr»jV'l 4 UfA \y& IfJJy -ill ! y^=* iyK"" li ^ ;3j1 ^ «iil oJj ^5 >5 pr^ pH- V iS>04A«; U^ Jij ft— ^XrA ^ V'- J»A irirVl ij 41S. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah. Such will be brought before their Lord, and the witnesses will say,"These are the ones who lied against their Lord!" No doubt! The curse ofAllah is on the wrongdoers.} 419. Those who hinder (others)from the path ofAllah, and seek a crookedness therein, while they are disbelievers in the Hereafter.} 420. By no means will they escape on earth, nor have they

43Surah VL Hud (18-22) (Part-12) protectors besides Allah! Their torment will be doubled! They could not bear to listen and they used not to see (the truth).} }21. They are those who have lost their own selves, and that which they invented eluded them.} 422 . Certainly, they are those who will be the greatest losers in the Hereafter.} Those Who invent Lies against Allah and hinder Others from His Path are the Greatest Losers Allah, the Exalted, explains the condition of those who lie against Him and that their scandal in the Hereafter will be presented before the heads of creation (for testimony) from the angels, Messengers, Prophets and the rest of mankind and Jinns. This is just as Imam Ahmad recorded from Safwan bin Muhriz. Safwan said, "I was holding the hand of Ibn Umar when a man was brought to him. The man said, 'How did you hear the Messenger of Allah 3g describe An-Najwa (secret counsel or confidential talk) on the Day of Resurrection?' Ibn Umar said, 1 heard him say, OJjAij -jA *,AXS jlip gMI-i OJ Oj bj i US' . b aJ (Jjjjj CjJI ^ fillip Jii Jls : Jls kitU ^ ij\jj iiJ U'jZS « Verily , Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, will draw near the believer and He will place His shade over him. He will conceal him from the people and make him confess to his sins. He will say to him, "Do you recognize this sin? Do you recognize that sin? Do you recognize such and such sin?" This will continue until He makes him confess to all of his sins and he (the believer) will think to himself that he is about to be destroyed. Then Allah will say, "Verily, I have concealed these sins for you in the worldly life and I have forgiven you for them today." Then he (the believer) will be given his Book ofgood deeds . As for the disbelievers and the hypocrites, the witnesses will say^ jc 4m\ sLil yt jl&j cP

iThese are the ones who lied against their Lord! No doubt! The curse ofAllah is on the wrongdoers.}."| 11 Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this narration in the Two Sahtfis.121 Concerning Allah's statement. iThose who hinder (others) from the path of Allah, and seek a crookedness therein,} This means that they prevent the people from following the truth and traversing upon the path of guidance that leads to Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. In doing so they also keep the people away from Paradise itself. Allah's statement, 4and seek a crookedness therein,} This means that they want their path to be crooked and uneven. Then, Allah's statement, iwhile they are disbelievers in the Hereafter.} This means that they deny the Hereafter and they reject the idea that any of its events will occur, or any of it exists at all. Concerning Allah's statement. 4 lit i>JJ oi ty 4 p ^PP} 4By no means will they escape on earth, nor have they protectors besides Allah!} This means that these disbelievers are under the power of Allah and His force. They are in His grasp and are subject to His authority. He is Most Able to exact vengeance against them in this life before the coming of the Hereafter. This is like Allah's statement,

ibut He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will Ahmad 2:74. Fath Al-Bari 8 :204 , and Muslim 4 :2120

stare in horror.}[14:42] In the Two Sahllhs it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, ,Jliy 2.1 !>[» ^Verily Allah gives respite to the oppressor until He seizes him, then he will not be able to escape Him.n111 For this reason Allah says, jvi iTheir torment will be doubled!} This means that the torment will be doubled upon them, because Allah gave them hearing, vision and hearts, but these things did not benefit them. Rather, they were deaf from hearing the truth and blinded away from following it. This is just as Allah has mentioned concerning them when they enter into the Hellfire. Allah says, A- j) iplij} 4And they will say: "Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!"} Allah also says, iThose who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them We will add torment to the torment.}[16:88] For this reason they will be punished for every command that they abandoned and every prohibition that they indulged in. Then Allah continues by saying, -Lai XfrfA. iThey are those who have lost their own selves, and that which they invented eluded them.} They lost themselves, meaning that they be made to enter a blazing Fire, where they will be punished, and its torment will not be lifted from them for even the blinking of an eye. This is as Allah said, HI Path. Al-Bari 8 :205 , and Muslim 4 :1997

iWhenever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire.>[17:97] Concerning the statement, jz>j\$ ieluded them.* meaning that it has left them. 'y\£=> U^ ithat luhich they invented - besides Allah, such as rivals and idols. Yet, these things did not avail them in the slightest. In fact, these things actually caused them great harm. This is as Allah says, 4 -i 'U-jff 'y\$ P IP' ^4>- 4And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.^[46:6] Allah says, 4 ^ — j iWhen those who were followed disown those who followed (them), and they see the torment, then all their relations loill be cut offfrom them .\$. [2:166] Likewise, there are many other verses that prove this loss of theirs and their destruction. For this reason Allah says, -JL ^ n >> 7 dj_r->V 4 |*f' (W iCertainly, they are those ivho will be the greatest losers in the Hearafter. [11:22] In this verse Allah informs about the direction of their end. He explains that they are the greatest losers among mankind in their transaction for the abode of the Hereafter. That is because they exchanged the highest levels (of Paradise) for the lowest levels (of Hell) and they substituted the pleasure of Gardens (of Paradise) for the fierce boiling water (of Hell). They exchanged the drink of sealed nectar with the fierce hot wind, boiling water, and a shade of black smoke. They chose food from the filth of dirty wounds instead of wide-eyed lovely

47Surah 11. Hud (23-24) (Part-12 maidens. They preferred Hdwiya (a pit in Hell) instead of lofty castles. They chose the anger of Allah and His punishment over nearness to Him and the blessing of gazing at Him. Therefore, it is no injustice that such people should be the greatest losers in the Hereafter. i*£j \$1 \$ k Ji 423. Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and humble themselves before their Lord, they will be the dwellers ofParadise to dwell therein forever. 424. The likeness of the two parties is as the blind and the deaf and the seer and the hearer. Are they equal when compared? Will you not then take heed?} Rewarding the People ofFaith When Allah, the Exalted, mentioned the condition of the wretched, He also commended the people of delight (the believers). They are those who believe and work righteous deeds. Thus, their hearts believed and their limbs

worked righteous deeds, both in statements and actions. This includes their performance of deeds of obedience and their abandonment of evils. In this way they are the inheritors of Gardens (of Paradise), which contain lofty rooms and seats arranged in rows. Therein they will find bunches of fruit near to them, elevated couches, fair and beautiful wives, various types of fruit, desired kinds of food and delicious drinks. They also will be allowed to see the Creator of the heavens and the earth and they will be in this state of pleasure forever. They will not die, nor will they grow old. They will not experience sickness, nor will they sleep. They will not have excrement, nor will they spit or snot. Their sweat will be the perfume of musk. The Parable of the Believers and the Disbelievers Then, Allah, the Exalted, makes a parable of the disbelievers and the believers. He says,

iThe likeness of the two parties This refers to those disbelievers whom Allah first described as wretched, and then those believers whom He described with delightfulness. The first group is like one who is blind and deaf, while the second group is like he who sees and hears. Thus, the disbeliever is blind from the truth in this life and in the Hereafter. He is not guided to goodness, nor does he recognize it. He is deaf from hearing the proofs, thus he does not hear that which would benefit him. As Allah says, 4^+-^ !£• pfi iHad Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen . \$[8:23] The believer is smart, bright and clever. He sees the truth and distinguishes between the truth and falsehood. Thus, he follows the good and abandons the evil. He hears and distinguishes between the proof and scepticism. Therefore, falsehood does not overcome him. Are these two types of people alike? iWill you not then take heed? \$ This statement means, “Will you not consider, so that you may distinguish between these two categories of people.” This is as Allah mentions in another verse, iLiJi > _>UJi kiLJa’t 4Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful>[59:20] Allah also says, % jJl* X> X> ciJLW? X) utyli Cji\$ ojI oj. j ije »tU & i>\ eJjH\ X Q.& XI j3 0; i&j fig.&

49Surah 11. Hud (25-27) (Part-12 Jr m imam 4Not alike are the blind and the seeing. Nor are (alike) darkness and light. Nor are (alike) the shade and the sun's heat. Nor are (alike) the living and the dead. Verily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear, but you cannot make hear those who are in graves. You are only a wamer. Verily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a wamer. And there never was a nation but a warner had passed among them.) [35:19- 24] -&j} ^ ft 4] at v>. *{£ sM &&&0G <2£ \% v« &£ c p£ c; //•/ ->^ ./<»/V >V . >*/x» »- L *6XPj4 <25. .And indeed We sent Nuh to his people (and he said): “I have come to you as a plain wamer.”} 426. “That you worship none but Allah; surely, I fear for you the torment of a painful Day.”} 427. The chiefs who disbelieved among his people said: “We see you but a man like ourselves, nor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking. And we do not see in you any merit above us, in fact we think you are liars.”}

50 Tafslr Ibn Kathir The Story of Nuh and His Conversation with His People Allah, the Exalted, informs about Prophet Nuh. He was the first Messenger whom Allah sent to the people of the earth who were polytheists involved in worshipping idols. Allah mentions that he (Nuh) said to his people, AS? yj 4!^ H have come to you as a plain wamer.} meaning, to openly warn you against facing Allah’s punishment if you continue worshipping other than Allah. Thus, Nuh said, 4 Si' "j AThat you worship none but Allah;} This can also be seen in his statement, A?S -ty. '£& SO isurely, Ifearfor you the torment of a painful

Day.} This means, “If you all continue doing this, then Allah will punish you with a severe punishment in the Hereafter.” Then Allah says, A*ify oi lift 5*3' \$&} iThe chiefs who disbelieved among his people said;} The word ‘chiefs’ (Al-Mala’u) here means the leaders and the heads of the disbelievers. They said, {fS Y) 0} 4We see you but a man like ourselves,} This means, “You are not an angel. You are only a human being, so how can revelation come to you over us? We do not see anyone following you except the lowliest people among us, like the merchants, weavers and similar people. No people of nobility, or rulers among us follow you. These people who follow you are not known for their intelligence, wit, or sharp thinking. Rather, you merely invited them (to this Islam) and they responded to your call and followed you (ignorantly).” This is the meaning of their statement, AS arf fS n <33 Sjly C,}

51Surah 11. Hud (25-27) (Part-12) inor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking. The statement, “without thinking,” means that they merely followed the first thing that came to their minds. Concerning the statement, ot££ Cj} 4And ive do not see in you any merit above us, in fact we think you are liars. In this they are saying, “We do not see that you [and your followers] have any virtuous status above us in your physical appearance, your character, your provisions, or your condition, since you accepted this (new) religion of yours.” iin fact we think you are liars.} This means, “We think you are lying about that which you are claiming for yourselves of righteousness, piety, worship and happiness in the abode of the Hereafter when you arrive there.” This was the response of the disbelievers to Nuh and his followers. This is a proof of their ignorance and their deficiency in knowledge and intelligence. For verily, the truth is not to be rejected because of the lowly status of those who follow it. Verily, the truth is correct in itself, regardless of whether its followers are of low status, or nobility. Actually, the reality concerning which there is no doubt, is that the followers of the truth are the noble ones, even though they may be poor. On the other hand, those who reject the truth are the lowly wretches, even though they may be wealthy. Thus, we see that usually the weakest of people are the ones who follow the truth, while the nobility and high-class people usually are opposed to the truth. This is as Allah says, Lay JI\$ VJ j'Si ^ Uu-Ji U iAnd similarly, We sent not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: “We found our fathers following a cerain way and religion, and we will indeedfollow theirfootsteps.”}[43:23] When Heraclius, the emperor of Rome, asked Abu Sufyan

Sakhr bin Harb about the qualities of the Prophet jg, he said to him, “Are his followers the noble people, or the weak?” Abu Sufyan said, “They are the weakest of them.” Then Heraclius said, “They (weak ones) are the followers of the Messengers.” Concerning their statement, (ifi) iwithout thinking.) In reality this is not objectionable, or something derogatory, because the truth when it is made clear, does not leave room for second-guessing, or excessive thinking. Rather, it is mandatory that it should be followed and this is the condition of every pious, intelligent person. No one continues doubtfully pondering the truth (after it is made clear) except one who is ignorant and excessively critical. The Messengers - Allah’s peace and blessings be upon them all - only delivered what was obvious and clear. Concerning Allah’s statement, 4And we do not see in you any merit above us,) They did not see this (the virtue of accepting Islam) because they were blind from the truth. They could not see, nor could they hear. Rather, they were wavering in their skepticism. They were wandering blindly in the darknesses of their ignorance. They, in reality, were the slanderers and liars, lowly and despicable. Therefore, in the Hereafter they will be the greatest losers. (Jj Cj* C-3 oj Jbp & 2k»)28. He said: “O

my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord, and a mercy (prophethood) has come to me from Him, but that (mercy) has been obscured from your sight. Shall we compel you (to accept) it when you have a strong hatred for it?) hi Fath Al-Bari 1 :42

53 Surah 11. Hud (29-30) (Part-12 The Response of Nuh Allah says, informing about the response of Nuh to his people, 4 Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord,} Bayyinah means certainty, a clear matter, and truthful prophethood. That is the greatest mercy from Allah upon him (Nuh) and them (his people). ibut that (mercy) has been obscured from your sight.} “Obscured from your sight” in this verse means, ‘it was hidden from you and you are not guided to it. Thus, you [people] did not know its importance so you hastily rejected and denied it.’ i Shall we compel you (to accept) it} This means, “Should we force you to accept it, while you actually detest it.” p-fr'i iy- * i Zj *i' j*- V', (sj^ VC V ^ j] \$ Oi O* tiji | '*rJ 429. And O my people! I ask of you no wealth for it, my reward is from none but Allah. I am not going to drive away those who have believed. Surely, they are going to meet their Lord, but I see that you are a people that are ignorant.} 430. And O my people! Who will help me against Allah, if I drove them away? Will you not then give a thought?} Nuh says to his people, “I do not ask you for any wealth in return for my sincere advice to you.” Wealth (Mai) here means, “payment that I take from you.” Nah means, “I am only seeking the reward from Allah, the Mighty and Sublime.” Concerning the statement, aft ti Zj} 41 am not going to drive away those who have believed.}

This alludes to the fact that they (the disbelievers) requested Nuh to disassociate himself from the believers, because they were averse to them and felt themselves too important to sit with them. This is similar to the request of disbelievers to the seal of the Messengers sjg to disassociate himself from a group of the people who were considered weak in their social status. They wanted the Prophet jg to sit with them in a special gathering of the elite. Therefore, Allah revealed, / ^ / ip/ - / •,*/ \ _*4Jj Ojfrjj 'jjf 4 And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and afternoon Allah also says, iif 02 , /ill O' 477i»s We have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) whom Allah has favored from among us?" Does not Allah know best those who are grateful?}\6:53] Ctk\$ %^ V; Vj <EI jxe j\$3 jjS 431 . Am/ I do not say to you that with me are the treasures of Allah, nor that I know the Ghayb; nor do I say I am an angel, and I do not say of those whom your eyes look down upon that Allah will not bestow any good on them. Allah knows what is in their inner selves. In that case, I should, indeed be one of the wrongdoers.)> Nuh is informing them that he is a Messenger from Allah, calling to the worship of Allah alone, without any partners and he is doing this by the permission of Allah. At the same time, he is not asking them for any reward for this work. He invites whomever he meets, whether of nobility or low class. Therefore, whoever responds favorably, then he has achieved salvation. He also explains that he has no power to manipulate the hidden treasures of Allah, nor does he have any knowledge of the Unseen, except what Allah has allowed him to know. Likewise,

Jr am TTfl mm ^i* i #/" • y ^ "" ^ »C (*r^J»614ii ^ Vj Jy^V)^ L*j *_l_i 1*3^ > ""*?/? -£ -£^ „ / >/• i <./ V> // > tlp Sji>-j£&£ZsJXj!S<4£l0^ - * - -'tit--' << ^ 5. IOjd^pp he is not an angel, rather, he is merely a human Messenger aided with miracles. Nuh goes on to say, “I do not say about these people whom you (disbelievers) detest and look down upon, that Allah will not reward them for their deeds. Allah knows best what is in their souls. If they are believers in their hearts, as their condition appears to be outwardly, then they will have a good reward. If anyone behaves evilly with them after they have

believed, then he is a wrongdoer who speaks what he has no knowledge of. Si £4- 4 V4 IL 1\$ CKp \$ £*& £&£ 3 j OjJ o). i^wu "S >4 t*j itl o) i#* jSS|i Jtt ,4; <5V.^ 4£ 432. They said: "O Niih! You have disputed with us, and much have you prolonged the dispute with us, now bring upon us what you threaten us with, if you are of the truthful."} 433. He said: "Only Allah will bring it (the punishment) on you, if He wills, and then you will escape not."} 434. "And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, if Allah's will is to keep you astray. He is your Lord! and to Him you shall return."}

The People's Request of Nuh to bring the Torment and His Response to Them Allah, the Exalted, informs that the people of Nuh sought to hasten Allah's vengeance, torment, anger and the trial (His punishment). This is based on their saying, iG'L o'li- ^4 \ji} iThey said: "O Nuh! You have disputed with us and much have you prolonged the dispute with us..."} They meant by this, "You (Nuh) have argued with us long enough, and we are still not going to follow you." inow bring upon us what you threaten us with,} What he (Nuh) promised is referring to the vengeance and torment (from Allah). They were actually saying, "Supplicate against us however you wish, and let whatever you have supplicated come to us." itS4 iil * pJ)i Jli ^ i "...if you are of the truthful." (In reply to this,) He said: "Only Allah will bring it (the punishment) on you, if He wills, and then you will escape not.^>(1 1:32-33] This means, It is only Allah Who can punish you and hasten your punishment for you. He is the One from Whom nothing escapes.' of 4p jfJ si 4^#£ i'} }And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, if Allah's will is to keep you astray.} This means: something that could be useful to you (in acceptance) of my preaching to you, warning you and advising you. ipP ol ij.% of o\} iif Allah's will is to keep you astray.} This means: your deception and your ultimate destruction.

iHe is your Lord! and to Him you shall return .} He is the Owner of the finality of all matters. He is the Controller, the Judge, the Most Just and He does not do any injustice. Unto Him belongs the creation and the command. He is the Originator and the Repeater (of the creation). He is the Owner of this life and the Hereafter. 4- r : 1*4 »3j-! jJ} 435. Or they (the pagans of Makkah) say: "He has fabricated it." Say: "If I have fabricated it, upon me be my crimes, but I am innocent of (all) those crimes which you commit.} An Interruption to verify the Truthfulness of the Prophet jg This is presented in the middle of the story to affirm the story itself. It is as if Allah, the Exalted, is saying to Muhammad 3g, "Or do these obstinate disbelievers say that he fabricated this and invented it himself?" iSay: "If I have fabricated it, upon me be my crimes..."} This means: such sin would be mine alone. iBut I am innocent of (all) those crimes which you commit.} This story is not invented, or fabricated falsely. Because he (the Prophet) knows better the punishment of Allah for one who lies on Allah. tV 3* & S& cs <1>P& 4p CT i>S C jil. jj V) niyi ^ <S*jJ J gy j', CfJ' j Vj o) ii* / U£=>j a cr 436. And it was revealed to Nuh: "None of your people will believe except those who have believed already. So be not sad because of what they used to do.}

437. "And construct the ship under Our Eyes and with Our revelation, and address Me not on behalf of those who did wrong; they are surely to be drowned."} }38. And as he was constructing the ship, whenever the chiefs of his people passed by him, they mocked at him. He said: "If you mock at us, so do we mock at you likewise for your mocking."} 439. "And you will know who it is on whom will come a torment that will cover him with disgrace and on whom will fall a lasting torment."} The

Revelation to Nuh concerning what would happen to the People and the Command to prepare for It Allah, the Exalted, sent revelation to Nuh when his people hastened the vengeance and punishment of Allah upon themselves. Then, Nuh supplicated against them, as Allah mentioned, when He said; > jji v •\$} 4My Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers inhabiting the earth!} [71:26] And he said, &Jj} 4Then he invoked his Lord (saying) : "I have been overcome, so help (me)"/"^[54:10] At this point Allah revealed to him, 4None of your people will believe except those who have believed already.} Therefore, do not grieve over them and do not be concerned with their affair. 4And construct the ship.} The word Fulk here means ship.

59Surah 11. Hud (35-39) (Part-12) funder Our Eyes} This means under Our vision. iand with Our revelation,} This means, "We will teach you (Nuh) what to do." pri 4 iand address Me not on behalf of those who did xorong; they are surely to be drowned.} Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned from the Tawrah, "Allah commanded him (Nuh) to make it (the ship) from Indian oak wood. Then He commanded him to make its length eighty cubits and its width fifty cubits. Allah then commanded him to coat its interior and exterior with tar and to make it with a slanted bow to part the water (as it sailed). Its height was thirty cubits into the sky. It had three levels and each level was ten cubits high. The lowest level was for the animals, both tame and wild, the second level was for the human beings and the highest level was for the birds. Its door was in the center of it and it had a cover on top of it that covered the entire ship."111 Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd as he was constructing the ship , whenever the chiefs of his people passed by him, they mocked at him.} This means that they teased him and rejected his threat that they would drown (in the forthcoming flood). iHe said: "If you mock at us, so do we mock at you likewise..."} This is a severe threat and a serious warning. t j-} 111 This narration is clearly from the Isra'Uiyat (stories of the Jews and Christians) and thus cannot be relied upon totally unless there is support for it from the authentic Hadiths of the Prophet jg.

forth. And We caused springs to gush forth from the earth. So the waters (of the heaven and the earth) met for a matter predestined. And We carried him on a (ship) made of planks and nails. Floating under Our Eyes: a reward for him who had been rejected!}[54: 11-14] In reference to Allah's statement, iand the oven gushed forth.} It is related from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "At-Tannur is the face of the earth."111 This verse means that the face of the earth became gushing water springs. This continued until the water gushed forth from the Tananir, which are places of fire. Therefore, water even gushed from the places where fire normally would be. This is the opinion of the majority of the Salaf (predecessors) and the scholars of the Khalaf (later generations). At this point, Allah commanded Nuh to select one pair from every kind of creature possessing a soul, and load them on the ship. Some said that this included other creatures as well, such as pairs of plants, male and female. It has also been said that the first of the birds to enter the ship was the parrot, and the last of the animals to enter was the donkey. Concerning Allah's statement, i\$ iand your family - except him against whom the Word has already gone forth This means, "Load your family upon the ship." This is referring to the members of his household and his relatives, except him against whom the Word has already gone forth, for they did not believe in Allah. Among them was the son of Nuh, Yam, who went in hermitage. Among them was the wife of Nuh who was a disbeliever in Allah and His Messenger. Concerning Allah's statement, iand those who believe.} from your people. m At-Tabari 15:318.

And none believed with hint, except a few.} This means that only a very small number believed, even after the long period of time that he (Nuh) was among them - nine hundred and fifty years. It is reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "They were eighty people including their women." vj iIlj oJ==>jt Sri 4 c-j'iSpj *34 4 VI 4' ^ Ol J"j4' V Jli t£S' or; 4^" 41 Jli i <J Si££ 5Cj XrJ 4 443 . And he said : "Embark therein : in the Name of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage. Surely, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} <\$42. So it (the ship) sailed with them amidst waves like mountains, and Nuh called out to his son, who had separated himself (apart) "O my son! Embark with us and be not with the disbelievers."} i43. The son replied: "I will betake myself to some mountain, it will save me from the water." Niih said: "This day there is no savior from the decree of Allah except him on whom He has mercy." And waves came in between them, so he (the son) was among the drowned.} The riding upon the Ship and Its sailing through the huge Waves Allah, the Exalted, says concerning Nuh, that he said to those whom he was commanded to carry them with him in the ship, 4Embark therein: in the Name, of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage.} This means that its sailing upon the surface of the water, the 111 At-Tabari 15:326.

63 Surah 11. Hud (41-43) (Part-12) end of its journeying and its anchoring, would all be with the Name of Allah. Abu Raja' Al-Tjaridi recited it, "In the Name of Allah, Who will be the One Who moves its course, and rests its anchor." 111 Allah, the Exalted, said. Jr csl»J, 4And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say: ",All the praises and thanks are to Allah, Who has saved us from the people who are wrongdoers. And say: "My Lord! Cause me to land at a blessed landing place, for You are the Best of those who bring to land."^[23:28-29] For this reason, it is preferred to mention the Name of Allah (Bismillah) at the beginning of all affairs. The Name of Allah should be mentioned when boarding a ship, or when mounting an animal. This is as Allah, the Exalted, says, £3 40 * % 3%, <\$ 4And Who has created all the pairs and has appointed for you ships and cattle on which you ride, in order that you may mount on their backs.^[43:12-13] This practice (mentioning Allah's Name) has been encouraged in the Sunnah and is considered a preferred act. A discussion concerning this is forthcoming in the explanation of Surat Az- Zukhruf (43), if Allah wills. In reference to Allah's statement, iSurely, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful> Such statement is suitable while mentioning (His) vengeance upon the disbelievers by drowning all of them. Therefore, he (Nuh) mentions that His Lord is Oft Forgiving, Most Merciful. (i| At-Jabari 15:328.

64 Tafstr Ibn Kathir This is similar to Allah's statement, 4^5^ ^ 614 iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} [7:167] He also says, .Ajj—i-i oi_j u]_j4 4B«i verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment.} [13:6] Likewise, there are many other verses that combine Allah's mercy and His vengeance. Concerning Allah's statement, 4jI^J? g? 4 At ajf 4So it sailed with them amidst waves like mountains,} This means that the ship sailed with them upon the surface of the water, which had completely covered the earth until it encompassed the tops of the mountains and even rose over them by a height of fifteen cubits. It was also said that the waves rose over the mountains by a height of eighty miles. Yet, this ship continued to move upon the water, sailing by the permission of Allah. It moved under His shade, His help, His protection and His blessing. This is as Allah, the Exalted, said, i{ }3# S3x& '<<&£ a6& iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the ship. That We might make it an admonition for you and it might be retained by the retaining ears.}

[69:1 1-12] Allah also said, 4And We carried him on a (ship) made of planks and nails, floating under Our Eyes: a reward for him who had been rejected! And indeed, We have left this as a sign. Then is there any that will remember (or receive admonition)?}[54:13-15]

The Story of the drowning of Nuh's Disbelieving Son Allah continues the story, saying, it#& iand Niih called out to his son,) This was the fourth son of Nuh. His name was Yam and he was a disbeliever. His father, Nuh, called him at the time of boarding the ship, that he might believe and embark with them. If he did so, he would be saved from drowning like the other disbelievers. iThe son replied: "I will betake myself to some mountain, it will save me from the water.") He believed, in his ignorance, that the flood would not reach the tops of the mountains and that if he clung to the top of a mountain, he would be saved from drowning. His father, Nuh, said to him, 4U-J cs •*!&/m jyS V) iThis day there is no savior from the decree of Allah except him on whom He has mercy.) This means that nothing will be saved today from the command of Allah. ile iAnd waves came in between them, so he (the son) was among the drowned.) JsVt itlii ^ ,if. 444. And it was said: "O earth! Swallow up your water, and O sky! Withhold (your rain)." And the water was made to subside and the decree was fulfilled. And it rested on (Mount) Judi, and it was said: "Away with the people who are wrongdoing!")

The End of the Flood Allah, the Exalted, informs that when the people of the earth were all drowned, except for the people on the ship, He commanded the earth to swallow its water, which had sprang from it and gathered upon it. Then He commanded the sky to cease raining. iAnd the water was made to subside This means that it (the water) began to decrease. i'N iand the decree was fulfilled> This means that all of those who disbelieved in Allah were removed from the people of the earth. Not a single one of them remained upon the earth. iAnd it (the ship) rested> This is referring to the ship and those who were in it. 'Pf ion (Mount) Judi Mujahid said, "Judi is a mountain in Al- Jazirah (Northwest Mesopotamia) where the mountains sought to tower above each other on the day of the drowning. On that day of destruction, all the mountains sought to be higher (to avoid being overcome by the water). However, this mountain (Judi) humbled itself for Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, and therefore it was not drowned. This is why Nuh's ship anchored upon it."111 Qatadah said, "The ship rested upon it (Mount Judi) for a month before they (the people) came down from it." Qatadah also said, "Allah made Nuh's ship remain on Mount Judi in the land of Al-Jazirah, as a lesson and a sign."12 ' Even the early generations of this Ummah saw it. How many ships are there that have come after it and have been destroyed and became dust? At-Tabari 15:337. 121 At-Tabari 15:338.

Surah VL Hud (45-47) (Part-12 iand it was said: "Away with the people who are wrongdoing!") means destruction and loss for them. The term "away with" here implies being far away from the mercy of Allah. For verily, they were destroyed to the last of them, and none of them survived. j* JU» TLj Q> tj) all ^ 3*1^ S; ,2i Jli i 4 ^ J Q 7>j jli "'i1 ; St j Si 4^ <45. And Niih called upon his Lord and said, "O my Lord! Verily, my son is of my family! And certainly, Your promise is true, and You are the Most Just of the judges.") 446. He said: "O Nuh! Surely, he is not of your family; verily, his work is unrighteous, so ask not of Me that of which you have no knowledge! I admonish you, lest you should be one of the ignorant,") 447. Nuh said: "O my Lord! I seek refuge with You from asking You that of which I have no knowledge. And unless You forgive me and have mercy on me, I would indeed be one of the losers.") AReturn to the Story of the Son of Nuh and mentioning what transpired between Nuh and Allah

concerning Him This was a request for information and an inquiry from Nuh concerning the circumstances of his son's drowning. 4and said, "O my Lord! Verily, my son is of my family!") This means, "Verily, You promised to save my family and Your promise is the truth that does not fail. Therefore, how can he (my son) be drowned and You are the Most Just of the judges?" 4^ S; J4 'A iUi Js»

68 Tahir Ibn Kathir 4He (Allah) said: "O Niih! Surely, he is not of your family..." } This means, "He (your son) is not of those whom I promised to save. I only promised you that I would save those of your family who believe." For this reason Allah said, iand your family except him against whom the Word has already gone forth. [1 1:40] Thus, for his son, it had already been decreed that he would be drowned due to his disbelief and his opposition to his father, the Prophet of Allah, Nuh peace be upon him. Concerning Allah's statement, ASurely, he is not of your family;} meaning that he (Nuh's son) was not among those whom Allah promised to save. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He was the son of Ntuh, but he opposed him in deeds and intention." Ikrimah said in some of the modes of recitation it said here, "Verily, he (Nuh's son) worked deeds that were not righteous." & Ja^ b 448. It was said: "O Nuh! Come down (from the ship) with peace from Us and blessings on you and on the people who are with you (and on some of their offspring), but (there will be other) people to whom We shall grant their pleasures (for a time), but in the end a painful torment will reach them from Us." } The Command to descend from the Ship with Peace and Blessings Allah, the Exalted, informs of what was said to Nuh when the ship anchored on Mount Judi, peace be upon him, peace m At-Tabari 15 :343

were sent upon him and the believers with him. This salutation was also for every believer from his progeny until

the Day of Resurrection. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, "Every

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2609–2673]

male and female believer until the Day of Resurrection is included in this salutation of peace. Likewise, every male and female disbeliever until the Day of Resurrection is included in this promise of torment and pleasure.¹¹¹ Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "When Allah wanted to stop the flood, He sent a wind upon the face of the earth that caused the water to be still. Then the springs of the earth were closed off from the great flooding and the pouring (rain) from the sky halted. Allah, the Exalted, says, iAnd it was said: "O earth! Swallow up your water... [11:44] Thus, the water began decreasing and subsiding until the ship settled on Mount Judi. The People of the Tawrah (the Jews) claim that this occurred during the seventh month (of the year) and it lasted for seventeen nights. Then, on the first day of the tenth month, he (Nuh) saw the mountain tops. Then after forty more days, Nuh opened the small window in the roof of the ship and he sent a raven out to see what the water had done. However, the raven did not return to him Then, he sent a pigeon out but it returned to him without finding any place (land) to put its two feet down. He extended his hand out of the ship and the pigeon grabbed his hand so that Nuh could pull it back into the ship. Then, after seven more days passed, he sent the pigeon out again to investigate for him. The pigeon returned in the evening with a leaf from an olive tree in its mouth. From this, Nuh knew that the water had decreased from the face of the earth. He remained in the ship for seven more days before he sent the pigeon out again. This time the pigeon did not return to him, so he knew that the

earth had appeared. Thus, a year was completed from the time that Allah sent the flood, until the time of Nuh sending the pigeon. The first day of the first month of the second year began when the face of the earth appeared and land became manifest. At-Tabari 15:353.

71 Surah 11. Hud (50-52) (Part-12 that it occurred, as if he witnessed it himself. which We reveal unto you;} This means, "We teach it to (Muhammad) as revelation from Us to you." you neither you nor your people knew it before this.} This means that neither you (Muhammad jfi) nor anyone of your people, have any knowledge of this. This is so that no one who rejects you can say that you learned it from him. Rather, it was Allah Who informed you of it in conformity with the true situation (of the story), just as the Books of the Prophets who were before you testify to. Therefore, you should be patient with the rejection of your people and their harming you. For verily, We shall help you and surround you with Our aid. Then, We will make the (good) end for you and those who follow you in this life and the Hereafter. This is what We did with the Messengers when We helped them against their enemies. 41*-** Lij >^} 4 Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe.} Allah also said, GjQ S)T ii? 4And, verily, Our Word is gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers, that they verily, would be made triumphant>(37:171-172] Then, Allah says, Ji juli) 4So be patient. Surely, the (good) end is for those who have Taqwa.} V.) 41 4 -AAC U ii' jli >,£ fc. yti isk £ 4 r-,1 g &J y^ 4 & ^ pZ>

450. And to the 'Ad (people We sent) their brother Hud. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Certainly, you do nothing but invent lies!" 451. "O my people I ask of you no reward for it (the Message). My reward is only from Him Who created me. Will you not then understand?" 452. "And O my people! Ask forgiveness of your Lord and then repent to Him, He will send you (from the sky) abundant rain, and add strength to your strength, so do not turn away as criminals."} The Story of Prophet Hud and the People of 'Ad Allah, the Exalted, says, 4And} This is an introductory to what is implied: "Verily, We sent." 4to the 'Ad (people) their brother Hud.} Hud came to them commanding them to worship Allah alone, without any associates. He forbade them from worshipping the idols which they made up, inventing names as gods. He informed them that he did not want any reward from them for his sincere advising and conveying of Allah's Message. He only sought his reward from Allah, the One Who created him. 4&Z *&} 4Will you not then understand?} Someone has come calling you to what will benefit your situation in this life and the Hereafter without asking for any wage (from them). Then he commanded them to seek the forgiveness of the One Who is capable of expiating previous sins. He also commanded them to repent for that which they may do in the future. Whoever has these characteristics, Allah will make his sustenance easy for him, grant him ease in his affairs and guard over his situation. For this reason Allah says, -j}

73 Surah VL Hud (53-56) (Part-12 4He will send you (from the sky) abundant rain, 453. They said: "O Hud! No evidence have you brought us, and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you.} 454. All that we say is that some of our gods (false deities) have seized you with evil (madness). He said: "I call Allah to witness and bear you witness that / am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship, > 455. Besides Him (Allah). So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite." 456. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path (the truth).} The

Conversation between (the People of) 'Ad and Hud Allah, the Exalted, informs that they said to their Prophet, 4^ C} 4No evidence have you brought us.} This means that they claimed that Hud had not brought them any proof or evidence for what he claimed. 4-Ms & ^4+!* S* &j} 4and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying!} They were saying how could his mere statement, "Leave these gods," be sufficient proof for them to leave their idols? t St£ 4and we are not believers in you.} This means that they did not believe what he was saying was

74 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAll that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil.} They were saying, "We think that some of our idols have afflicted you with madness and insanity in your intellect because you are trying to stop them from being worshipped and defame them." oi lij ?!Jy-; Ji 4He said: "I call Allah to witness and bear you witness, that I am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship besides Him (Allah) .>[1 1:54-55] Here, he is saying, "Verily, I am innocent of all of the rivals and idols (that you associate with Allah). iSo plot against me, all of you,} you and your gods if they are true." iand give me no respite.} the blinking of an eye." Then, Allah says, S* ck ^ jf)\$ jcm 41 put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock.} Every creature is under His (Allah's) power and His authority. He is the Best Judge, the Most Just, Who does not do any injustice in His ruling. For verily. He is upon the straight path. Verily, this argument contains a far-reaching proof and absolute evidence of the truthfulness of what Hud had come to them with. It also proves the falsehood of them worshipping idols that could not benefit nor harm them. Rather, these idols were inanimate objects that could not hear, see, befriend, or make enmity. The only One Who is worthy of having worship directed solely towards Him is Allah alone, without any partners. He is the One in Whose Hand is the sovereignty and

Jj tta cjjJtSsLAjjj^f"p oJ^r^U-j \5^3jj4j \$ 9Xr*^P*~£ ^sc. • y>tg&tA;t£)J©/ - i. *' fc\$£#50(^4 bjJtjtjl* juJL*juVj He is in control of all things. There is nothing except that it is under His ownership, power and authority. Thus, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and there is no Lord other than Him. di-j u <£M& >ii 4b Uy aj '\$\$['ft jj iL *—• Vi^ :t C3; %&£. t£ \$ 'fZ \pa uM 6£ o4 #1 i<' •- •t'-'l' i«- / " » ** ^ ^ yjl!j [jJU i> jlfi dllij , jijf' 4 5*~i b •'J-J |^y 4 IA^j *K yl^ j;^ ^ G'i i .ji >q ia2 vl& & h\ 4 . -?j» 457. So if you turn away, still I have conveyed the Message with which I was sent to you. My Lord will make another people succeed you, and you will not harm Him in the least. Surely, my Lord is Guardian over all things. 458. And when Our commandment came, V\!e saved Hud and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us, and We saved them from a severe torment.} 459. Such were [the people of] 'Ad. They rejected the Ayat of their Lord and disobeyed His Messengers, and followed the command of every proud, obstinate (oppressor of the truth from their leaders).}

76 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 460. And they were pursued by a curse in this world and (so they will be) on the Day of Resurrection . No doubt! Verily, 'Ad disbelieved in their Lord. So away with 'Ad, the people of Hud> Hud says to them, "If you turn away from that which I have brought to you in reference to worship of Allah, Who is your Lord alone, without any partners, then the proof has been established against you. This is because I have conveyed the Message of Allah to you, which He has sent me with." Ljj j 4My Lord will make another people succeed you,} This refers to a group of people who will worship Allah alone, without associating anything with Him. This also implies that the polytheists do not bother Allah and they do not harm Him in the least with their disbelief. To the contrary, their

disbelief merely harms their own selves. 4jLo- ^ iSurely, my Lord is Guardian over all things.} This means that Allah is a Witness and Guardian over the statements of His servants and their actions. He will give them due recompense for their actions. If they do good deeds. He will reward them with good. If they do evil, He will punish them with evil. The Destruction of the People of 'Ad and the Salvation of Those among Them Who believed 4& it 4And when Our commandment came,} This is referring to the barren wind with which Allah destroyed them, to the very last of them. The mercy and kindness of Allah, the Exalted saved Hud and his followers from this terrible punishment. JL * /,<' f > S* Mi'' Tp-rj y*d% yf iSuch were 'Ad (people). They rejected the Ayat of their Lord This means they disbelieved in the proofs and revelations (of

**» Allah) and they disobeyed the Messengers of Allah. This is due to the fact that whoever disbelieves in a Prophet, then verily, he has disbelieved in all of the Prophets, peace be upon them. There is no difference between any one of them, in the sense that it is necessary to believe in all of them. Therefore, 'Ad disbelieved in Hud and their disbelief was considered disbelief in all of the Messengers. A\$\$ 4and followed the command of every proud, obstinate.} This means that they abandoned following their rightly guided Messenger and they followed the command of every proud, obstinate person. Thus, they were followed in this life by a curse from Allah and His believing servants whenever they are mentioned. On the Day of Resurrection a call will be made against them in front of witnesses. 4Verily, 'Ad disbelieved in their Lord .} 5; yt jS C Si' fjhj J'< jli 461. And to Thamud (people We sent) their brother Salih. He said: "O my people! Worship Allah you have no other god but Him. He brought you forth from the earth and settled you therein, then ask forgiveness of Him and turn to Him in repentance. Certainly, my Lord is Near (to all by His knowledge), Responsive."} The Story of Salih and the People of Thamud Allah, the Exalted, says, 4And} This is an introduction to that which is implied, "Verily, We sent." 4to Thamud} They were a group of people who were living in cities carved from the rocks, between Tabuk and Al-Madlnah

(in Arabia). They lived after the people of 'Ad, so Allah sent to them, 4their brother Salih .^ He (Salih) commanded them to worship Allah alone. He said to them, <4\$SP&& iHe brought you forth from the earthy This means: 'He began your creation from it (the earth). From it He created your father, Adam.' iftt \$ 4and settled you therein,} This means: 'He made you prosperous in the earth. You are settled in it and you treasure it.' 4then ask forgiveness} This is in reference to your previous sins.' && iand turn to Him in repentance.} This is in reference to the future.' VO1 OJ 4Certainly, my Lord is Near (to all by His knowledge), Responsive.} This is similar to Allah's statement, lit t-JjJl 4And when My servants ask you concerning Me, then (answer them), I am indeed Near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant when he calls on Me.} [2:186] -Mi 1* Txi iy* ii • - i - - <'•*>, . »>*/J »; /. < * <. *5>>« : "r .<•* J »'< >\ r . > > ^ 462. TTiey saiW: "O Sail/?/ You have been among us as a figure of good hope until this! Do you (now) forbid us the worship of what our fathers have worshipped? But we are really in grave

*S doubt as to that to which you invite us."} 463. He said: "O my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord, and there has come to me a mercy from Him, who then can help me against Allah, if I were to disobey Him? Then you increase me not but in loss."} The Conversation between Salih and the People of Thamud Allah, the Exalted, mentions what transpired in the discussion between Salih and

his people. Allah informs of their ignorance and obstinacy in their statement, Jj 1 iLi 4You have been among us as a figure of good hope till this!} They were saying in this, “We had hope in your strong intellect before you began saying what you have said.” si: 4Do you (now) forbid us the worship of what our fathers have worshipped?} “what those who were before us were upon.” ii» ob.j £\j} 4But we are really in grave doubt as to that which you invite us.} This alludes to the great amount of doubt that they had. 44-3m oj jf-iO fyk &} 4He said : "O my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord..." } In reference to what He (Allah) has sent me with to you, I am upon conviction and sure evidence.' u*- * *-r-J <-< <jr> 4and there has come to me a mercy from Him, who then can help me against Allah, if I were to disobey Him?} ‘and abandon calling you to the truth and the worship of Allah alone. If I did so, you would not be able to bring me any

tJ1 &?*-.- TTt ,, /> > .> »/• , < / ci--**J irZj^f.uP jU .? > -i* >>*/" ' • > > " ^ > •^iSiSa '^ benefit, nor increase ^li-U J^=>"£Lajjjj j»^=jta^i^cu_!JHL-AjyL«j ^ ^ k—J_5JxSvla A^jll 4-*s»p-t-i ^S,J-? '(vr;^bj ^ ci\|j—jlljU-iiC-V i_j!^i '•t' "<' jJU^ me 4^-ii <fc>f in loss.}' This means loss and ruin. <!' ijli .»jjt J^=>U tijjjs i-j'l (»fe=tl X> jilf Je)> V, ^Ei-> 'V.v</ vU* £liU (*^=V^ 4 /*- *- ^ -U-j CiJJ' LUi .. 1J ">jj^S /*- " lid-^ bj? C . J-?ui <4sz ca> '—*i >*-»^ .•j”•. jf^4' Gyift j* iitj <jj \f£> jDj ipC-JU3* rfsii j IJ4& v>< .;bj+> o; Vi ir* oV >ju) jif i»;- rr-> iv^=> AS'>f3 <64. "And O my people! This she-camel of Allah is a sign to you, so leave her to graze in Allah's land, and touch her not with evil, lest a near torment should seize you." } <65. But they slaughtered her. So he said: "Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. This is a promise (a threat) that will not be belied." } <66. So when Our commandment came. We saved Salih and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us, and from the disgrace of that Day. Verily, your Lord - He is the All-Strong, the All-Mighty.} 467 . And As-Sayhah (awful cry) overtook the wrongdoers, so

they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.)468. As if they had never lived there. No doubt! Verily, Thamud disbelieved in their Lord. So away with Thamud!) A discussion of this story has already preceded in Surat Al- A'raf and it is sufficient without having to be repeated here. Allah is the Giver of success. j 3J & \)b otM S:t SHj) V 4jL£ tri *?! ^ Of**.- ! Au ow d>*% ^ £'iv>Jyl -jo* d! <& <&» iiV.\$3 jju 'yT, M Jlii £3* #ii' cS*b ^ Si 469. And verily, there came Our messengers to Ibrahim with the glad tidings. They said : "Saldman (greetings or peace!)" He answered, “Salamun (greetings or peace!),” and he hastened to entertain them with a roasted calf.) 470. But when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them, and conceived a fear of them. They said: "Fear not, we have been sent against the people of Lilt.") 471. And his wife was standing (there), and she laughed. But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.) 472. She said (in astonishment): 'Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband an old man? Verily, this is a strange thing!') 473. They said: "Do you wonder at the decree of Allah? The mercy of Allah and His blessings be on you, O the family [of Ibrahim]. Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All- Glorious.") The Coming of the Angels to Ibrahim and Their Glad Tidings to Him of Ishaq and Ya'qub Allah, the Exalted, says, 4liij 4And verily, there came Our messengers) The word “messengers” here means angels.

to Ibrahim with the glad tidings.} It has been said that the word “the glad tidings” means, “Receive the glad tidings of Ishaq.” Others have said that it means, “The destruction of the people of Prophet Lut.” The proof of the correctness of the first view is in Allah's statement, 4 4/- \$ [f- iThen when the fear had

gone away from (the mind of) Ibrahim, and the glad tidings had readied him, he began to plead with Usfor the people ofLut.}[11 :74] Jli iThey said: "Salaman." He answered, "Salamun."} This means, "Upon you." The scholars of explanation have said, "Ibrahim's reply of Salamun was better than that with which they had greeted him with, because the subjective case (Salamun instead of Salaman) alludes to affirmation and eternity." & J iand he hastened to entertain them with a roasted calf.} This means that he (Ibrahim) left with haste in order to bring them food, as a host. The food that he brought was a calf. The word Hanidh means roasted upon heated stones. This meaning has been reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and others. This is as Allah has said in another verse. <3u rijli iThen he turned to his household, and brought out a roasted calf. And placed it before them (saying): "Will you not eat?"} [51 :26-27] This verse contains many aspects of the etiquettes of hosting guests. IU At-Tabari 15:384, 385.

Silrah 11. Hud (69-73) (Part-12 y pr: ' \$*} 4Bi<f when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them,} This means that he felt estranged from them. 4*4* J'-\$»¥ iand conceived a fear of them.} This is because angels are not concerned with food. They do not desire it, nor do they eat it. Therefore, when Ibrahim saw them reject the food that he had brought them, without tasting any of it at all, he felt a mistrust ofthem. 4 *4* {& jZ-jj} iand conceived a fear of them.} As-Suddi said, "When Allah sent the angels to the people of Lut, they set out walking in the form ofyoung men, until they came to Ibrahim and they were hosted by him. When Ibrahim saw them, he rushed to host them. 4 v •yi*' -ill {[}] iThen he tamed to his household, and brought out a roasted calf.}[51:26] He slaughtered it (the calf), roasted it on hot stones and brought it to them. Then, he sat down with them, when he placed it before them, (saying): 'Will you not eat?' They said, 'O Ibrahim! Verily, we do not eat food without a price.' Ibrahim then said, Verily, this food has a price.' They said, What is its price?' He said, "You must mention the Name of Allah over it before eating it and praise Allah upon finishing it.' Jibril then looked at MikaTl and said, This man has the right that his Lord should take him as an intimate friend.' 4(U^=c &\ 44 v £.J\ \Z&} iBut when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them,} When Ibrahim saw that they were not eating, he became scared and frightened by them. Then, when Sarah looked and saw that he was honoring them, she began to serve them and she was laughing. She said, What amazing guests we have.

£4 Tafsir Ibn Kathlr We serve them ourselves, showing them respect and they do not eat our food.'" Then, concerning Allah's statement about the angels, 4GZ v \&) 4They said: "Fear not,") They were saying, "Do not be afraid of us. Verily, we are angels sent to the people of Lut in order to destroy them." Then, Sarah laughed in delight of the good news of their destruction. This is because they had caused much corruption and their disbelief was severe. For this reason, she was rewarded with the glad tidings of a son, even after her despair. Concerning Allah's statement, vy-i ?jj 4Mr iand after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.) This means that the son that she was going to have would have a son (her grandson) who would succeed him and beget many children. For verily, Ya'qub was the son of Ishaq, just as Allah says in Surat Al-Baqarah, jSm ij!j tS-Cu jj-AjLu b A-XJ Jfi ojllf CjjAjo 4 0 ft ft l 4 4] (jIM ft J *' 'jj r-' ft 40r were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub? When he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, "We shall worship your God, the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Ishaq, One God, and to him we submit.") [2:133] From this point in this verse there is an evidence for those who say that Isma'il was the son of Ibrahim who was to be sacrificed. It could not have been

Ishaq, because the glad tidings were given that he would have a son born to him named Ya'qub. So how could Ibrahim be commanded to sacrifice him when he was a small child and there had not been born to him a child yet, named Ya'qub, who was promised? The promise of Allah is true and there is no m At-Tabari 15 :389

Surah VL Hud (69-73) (Part-U) 85 breaking of Allah's promise. Therefore, it is not possible that Ibrahim was to sacrifice this child (Ishaq) with the condition being as it was. This makes it clear that Ismail was the son that was to be sacrificed and this is the best, most correct and clearest evidence of that. And all praise is due to Allah. 4J: ^ bV, 111;\$£ iShe said (in astonishment): "Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband an old man?"} Allah speaks of her statement in this verse, just as He spoke of her action in another verse. / U y f I^ * // y / •/ iThen his wife came forward with a loud voice: she smote her face, and said: "A barren old woman!"}[5\29] This was the custom of the women in their speech and actions when they were expressing amazement. 4Then said: "Do you wonder at the decree ofAllah?"} This means that the angels were saying to her, "Do not be amazed at the command of Allah, for verily, whenever He wants something, He merely says 'Be' and it is. So do not be amazed at this, even though you are old and barren and your husband is a very old man. Verily, Allah is able to do whatever He wills." m if%^ ji'& #&& iThe mercy of Allah and His blessing be on you, O the family (of Ibrahim). Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All-Glorious.} This means that He is the Most Praiseworthy in all of His actions and statements. He is praised and glorified in His Attributes and His Self. For this reason, it is confirmed in the two Sahihs that they (the Prophet's Companions) said, "Verily, we already know how to greet you with Salam (peace), but how do we send Salah (prayer) upon you, O Messenger of Allah?" He 3^ said,

h** J* JP* r^ 'Ah olL» LIS' jl ^1pj JI ^3 oLii iiji',j Ji JU 0*31; ui jIa; 4 ^ ^ ^ x ® / , ^ JL^ » . * 1 1 1 j\ 'Say, "O Allah, send prayers upon Muham- mad and the family of Muhammad, just as You have sent prayers upon Ibrahim and the family of Ibrahim. And bless Muhammad and the fa- mily ofMuhammad, just as You have blessed the family of Ibrahim. Trtdy, You are the All- Praiseworthy, All-Glorious ."s111 tr- mm . •'>> \s ' *1,1 IJLAs, * JjHC-ljiJ «AjJ \$v*5**c£ ' X. c •AiKAK's- JbiUAi&pJu£ A^j * ^ t**/ . I*' »>'i ^ *i WJtSQ? ',Xc'(vf"prl-*^*U03 1JCaJ5j\cji jit? Ld-L)'—>*W- litjj ijUl*c~<Ac_ulijJ\i Jj ®J villii (jltliijJ— y*yi Ji^ \$ ^ Si :<j,j^ 4 d4. c&2® £pf p*j> ^ £K cs> J* L>\Yc. jlpj'i j£[3^^ ^r Ji /£• Ui> o® {£}£•. 474. Then zohen the fear had gone away from (the mind of) Ibrahim, and the glad tidings had readied him, he began to plead with Us (Our messengers) for the people of Lilt.} 475. Verily, Ibrahim was, witlwut doubt, forbearing, used to invoke Allah with humility, and was repentant.} 476. "O Ibrahim! Forsake this. Indeed, the commandment of your Lord has gone forth. Verily, there will come a torment for them which cannot be turned back."} [1 ' Path Al-Bari 6 : 469 , and Muslim 1 :305

87Surah U. Hud (74-76) (Part-12) The Dispute ofIbrahim over the People ofLut Allah, the Exalted, informs of what happened after the fright of Ibrahim left him and he felt no more fear of the angels when they refused to eat. After this, they gave him the glad tidings of the birth of a son and the destruction of the people of Lut. When they told him of this, he spoke to them as Said bin Jubayr narrated concerning this verse. Said said: When Jibril and the other angels who were with him came to Ibrahim, they said, &&& iVerily, we are going to destroy the people of this town .> Ibrahim said to

them, "Will you destroy a town that has three hundred believers in it?" They said, "No." He then said, "Will you destroy a town that has two hundred believers in it?" They said, "No." He said, "Will you destroy a town that has forty believers in it?" They said, "No." He then said, "Thirty?" They still replied, "No." This continued until he said, "Five?" They said, "No." Then he said, "What do you think if there is one Muslim man in the town, would you destroy it?" They said, "No." With this, Ibrahim ^{jg} said, ^{ta ^} ^{yu tSJ i}But there is Lut in it. They said: "We know better who is there. We will verily, save him and his family except his wife."} Therefore, Ibrahim remained silent and his soul was at rest.¹¹¹ Concerning Allah's statement, ⁱVerily, Ibrahim was, without doubt, forbearing, used to invoke Allah with humility, and was repentant (to Allah).} [11:751 This is a commendation for Ibrahim because of these beautiful characteristics Then Allah says, ^{dp\$ J» /il 'Ji£ m} At-Tabari 15:403.

^{\$0} Ibrahim! Forsake this. Indeed, the commandment of your Lord has gone forth.} This means the decree was settled concerning them and the Word was already given that they should be destroyed. The evil torment was coming to them, that cannot be averted from wicked people. ^{A*ji* ,*»Vj fj; 1^1* Jlij jrj: Oil*. 'jSiU j\$3 OjIL*; iylT j4 jy^ « && !# & jdi S\$ cgz 4 t & 4.*>4^ C 5&J «5|S v^-} 477. And when Our messengers came to Lut, he was grieved on account of them and was concerned for them. He said: "This is a distressful day."} 478. And his people came rushing towards him, and since aforetime they used to commit crimes, he said: "O my people! Here are my daughters, they are purer for you. So have Taqwa of Allah and disgrace me not with regard to my guests! Is there not among you a single right-minded man?"} 479. They said: "Surely, you know that we have no need of your daughters, and indeed you know well what we want!"} The Coining of the Angels to Lut, His Grief, and His Discussion with His People Allah, the Exalted, informs about the coming of His messenger angels. After they informed Ibrahim of their mission to destroy the people of Lut, they left him and set out to destroy Lut's people that very night. After leaving Ibrahim, they came to Lut. Some say that they came to him while he was on a piece of land that belonged to him. Others say that they came to him while he was in his home. They approached him while they were in the most handsome of forms. They appeared in the forms of young men with handsome faces. This was a test from Allah that contained much wisdom and a firm evidence. Their appearance saddened him (Lot) and he felt grief in his soul because of them. He was afraid that if he did not host them as his guests, someone else of his people

89 Surah 11. Hud (77-79) (Part-12) would host them and harm them. ⁴He said: "This is a distressful day."} Ibn 'Abbas and others said that this means, "A severe test for him." This was because he knew that he would have to defend them and it would cause great problems for him. Qatadah said, "They came to him while he was on a piece of land that belonged to him. They requested him to host them. He agreed, but he was shy of them and he walked in front of them. On the way to his home he said to them in attempt to convince them to go away, 'By Allah, I do not know any people on the face of the earth more wicked and disgusting than these people of this town.' Then he walked on a little further. Then he repeated the same statement to them. He continued doing this until he had repeated the same thing four times." Then Qatadah said, "They were ordered not to destroy them until their Prophet testified against them of this."¹²¹ Concerning Allah's statement, ⁱrushing towards him.} meaning, they made haste and rushed due to their delight of this (new young men). Concerning the statement, ^{qA*-*; \i^ m} }} and since aforetime they used to commit crimes.} This means that this did not cease being their behavior until they were seized (by Allah's torment) and they were still in the same condition. ^{i f£j cA }} He said:

"O my people! Here are my daughters (the women of the nation), they are purer for you..." } This was his attempt to direct them to their women, for verily 111 At-Tabari 15:411. 121 At-Tabari 15:408.

the Prophet is like a father for his nation. Therefore, he tries to guide them to that which is better for them in this life and the Hereafter. This is similar to his statement to them in another verse, ? p 'Jt pi 4Go you in unto the males of the nation, and leave those whom Allah has created for you to be your wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people!^26:165-166] Allah said in another verse, uiii digp r)£\$ 4They (the people of the city) said: "Did we not forbid you from entertaining any of the 'A/flwfnP'X15:70] This means, "Didn't we forbid you from hosting men (male) guests?" rfjG J) pr) id 'ji£ ~df>. 4[hut] said: "These (the girls of the nation) are my daughters, if you must act (so)." Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.>(15:71-72] Then, Allah said, in this noble verse, ip iHere are my daughters, they are purer for you. Mujahid said, "Actually, they were not his daughters, but they were from among his nation. Every Prophet is like a father to his nation."111 A similar statement has been reported from Qatadah and others. 121 Concerning the statement, 4So have Taqwa of Allah and disgrace me not with regard to my guests!} At-Jabari 15:414. At-Tabari 15:413.

91Surah IT Hud (80-81) (Part-12) This means, "Accept what I command you by limiting the fulfillment of your desires to your women." & £*S\$> Us there not among you a single right-minded man?} This means, "Is there not a good man among you who will accept what I am enjoining upon you and abandon what I have forbidden for you?" iThey said: "Surely you know that we have no need of your daughters .. ."} This means, "Verily, you know that we do not want our women, nor do we desire them." 4ijz&^0 4and indeed you blow well what we want!} This means, "We only want males and you know that. So what need is there for you to continue speaking to us about this?" 'Ash <4 dp S-i ty. Pf!> 4^ sj'* ii •j» 4 J ji H} ^ CT^ 5 ' (*^"4* prZ^ 480. He said: "Would that I had strength to overpower you, or that I could betake myself to some powerful support."} 481. They (messengers) said: "O Liit! Verily, we are the messengers from your Lord! They shall not reach you! So travel with your family in a part of the night, and let not any of you look back; but your wife (will remain behind), verily, the punishment which will afflict them, will afflict her. Indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near?"} Lut's Inability, His Desire for Strength and the Angels' Informing Him of the Reality Allah, the Exalted says that Lut was threatening them with his statement, <3£ 4 3

4Would that I had strength (men) to overpower you,} meaning, 1 would surely have made an example of you and done (harm) to you from myself and my family.' In this regard, there is a Hadith which is reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said, iSjk jil i>jj 4ui vJ-j Jri IjJ (J? & l/i ill aMay Allah's mercy be upon Lut, for verily, he betook himself to a powerful support -[meaning Allah, the Mighty and Sublime.] Allah did not send any Prophet after him, except amidst [an influential family] among his people With this, the angels informed him that they were the messengers of Allah sent to them. They also told him that his people would not be able to reach him (with any harm). iThey (messengers said): "O Lilt! Verily, we are the messengers from your Lord! They shall not reach you!} They commanded him to travel with his family during the last part of night and that he should follow them from behind. In this way it would be as though he were driving his family (as a cattle herder). li and let not any of you look back;} This means, "If you hear the sound of what (torment) befalls them (the people of the village), do not rush towards that disturbing noise. Rather, continue leaving." ^} ibut

your wife,} Most of the scholars said that this means that she would not travel at night and she did not go with Lot. Rather, she stayed in her house and was destroyed. Others said that it means that she looked back (during the travel). This later group says that she left with them and when she heard the inevitable destruction, she turned and looked back. When hi At-Tirmidhi no . 3 116

93Surah 11. Hud (82-83) (Part-12) she looked she said, "O my people!" Thus, a stone came down from the sky and killed her. Then they (the angels) brought close to him the destruction of his people as good news for him, because he said to them, "Destroy them in this very hour." They replied, indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near?} They were saying this while Luts people were standing at his door. They tried to rush his door from all sides and Lut was standing at the door repelling them, deterring them and trying to prevent them from what they were doing. Yet, they would not listen to him. Instead, they threatened him and sought to intimidate him. At this point, Jibril came out to them and struck them in their faces with his wing. This blow blinded their eyes and they retreated, unable to see their way. This is as Allah said, 4A,j^j qUe 'jijJj l-'llii if- tijj'j 4And they indeed sought to shame his guest (asking to commit sodomy with than). So We blinded their eyes (saying), "Then taste you My torment and My warnings."^[54:37] *aT) j A Lfio Ji Ji&jQj 482. So when Our commandment came, We turned them upside down, and rained on them stones of clay, in an array.} 483. Marked from your Lord; and they are not ever far from the wrongdoers.} The Town of Lut's People is overturned and Their Destruction Allah, the Exalted, says, H'J\ a} 4So when Our commandment came,} This happened at sunrise.

4We [turned it]...} The city ofSadum (Sodom) iupside down,} This is similar to Allah's statement, 4So there covered than that which did cover (torment with stones).}53:54] This means, "We rained upon it with stones made of SijjU." SijjU is a Persian word meaning stones made of clay. This definition has been mentioned by Ibn 'Abbas and others. 111 Some of the scholars said that it (SijjU) derived from the word Sang, which means a stone. Some others said it means Wakil, which is clay. In another verse Allah says, ithe stones of clay,} This means clay made into strong, hard stone. Some of the scholars said it means baked clay. Al- Bukhari said, "SijjU means that which is big and strong." Concerning Allah's statement, 4in an array.} Some of the scholars said that Mandud means the stones were arranged in the heavens and prepared for that (destruction). Others said, 4in an array.} This word means that some of them (the stones) followed others in their descent upon the people of Lut. Concerning the statement, i^y^} 4^Marked meaning the stones were marked and sealed, all of them having the names of their victims written on them. Qatadah and Ikrimah both said, "Musdwwamah means each m At-Tabari 15:434.

Surah YL Hud (84) (Part-12) 95 stone was encompassed by a sprinkling of red coloring." The commentators have mentioned that it (the shower of stones) descended upon the people of the town and upon the various villages around it. One of them would be speaking with some people when a stone would strike him from the sky and kill him while he was among the people. Thus, the stones followed them, striking the people in the entire land until they destroyed them all. Not a single one of them remained. Concerning Allah's statement, ot Jt iand they are not everfarfrom the wrongdoers.} This means that this vengeance (of Allah) is not far from similar wrongdoers. Verily, it has been reported in a Hadith of the Sunan collections, from Ibn 'Abbas, which he attributed to the Prophet %, «Whoever you

find doing the deed of Lut's people [homosexuality] , then kill the doer and the one who allows it to be done to him (both partners).»f21 4 'S', CAm oCl Xj}j {Zssae& xi\ 3'3>Jb 3U»J' 484. And to the Madyan people (We sent) their brother Shu'ayb. He said: "O my people! Worship Allah, you have no other god but Him, and give not short measure or weight. I see you in prosperity and verily, I fear for you the torment of a Day encompassing."}

The Story of the People of Madyan and the Call of Shu'ayb Allah, the Exalted, says, "We sent a Messenger to the people of Madyan.' They were a tribe of Arabs who lived between the land of the Al-Hijaz and Ash-Sham, close to the land of Ma'an. 1,1 At-Jabari 15:438. Abu Dawud no.4462, At-Tirmidhi no.1456 and Ibn Majah, no.

Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr Their land was known by the name of their tribe and was thus, called Madyan. Allah sent unto them the Prophet Shu'ayb and he was of the noblest of them in lineage. For this reason, Allah said, 4their brother Shu'ayb.} Shu'ayb commanded them to worship Allah alone without asso- ciating any partners with him. He also pro- hibited them from cheating in their weights and measures (for business transac- tions). 41 see you in prosperity meaning, 'in your livelihood and your provisions. And verily, I fear that you will be deprived of this bounty that you are enjoying by violating Allah's prohibitions.' ^ oCl Zi}j} 4and verily, I fear for you the torment of a Day encompassing.} This means the abode of the Hereafter. . if > / X •> < 485. "And O my people! Give fidl measure and weight in justice and reduce not the things that are due to the people, and do not commit mischief in the land, causing corruption."}

486. "That which is left by Allah is better for you, if you are believers. And I am not a guardian over you."4 First, he (Shu'ayb) prohibited them from cheating in business by decreasing the weights whenever they gave (products) to people. He commanded them to give just measure and weight whether they were giving or receiving (in transactions). He also forbade them from causing mischief and corruption in the land. This was due to their practice of highway robbery along the roads. Abu Ja'far bin Jarir said, ip£ iThat which is left by Allah (after giving the rights of the people) is better for you,} This means what you gain from your successful business dealings in which you have given just measure, is better for you than wrongfully taking the wealth of the people." Ibn Jarir said that this statement has been reported from Ibn 'Abbas and I say it is similar to Allah's statement, ifyLLj ^ js^ 4Say : "Not equal are Khabith (all that is evil) and Tayyib (all that is good), even though the abundance of Khabith may please you."H5:100J Allah then says, 4M* ia 4And I am not a guardian over you.} This means a watcher over you people. In other words, "Do this for Allah and not to be seen by the people." L* Uyi ili £ Ajl jl A'p *. \J£> } i jluk 487. They said: "O Shu'ayb! Does your Salah command you that we give up what our fathers used to ivorship, or that we give up doing what we like with our property? Verily, you are the forbearer, right-minded!"121 At-Tabari 15:447. ^ They said this sarcastically.

The Response of Shu'ayb's People They said to Shu'ayb, in mockery, iDoes your Salah} Al-A'mash said, "This means your reading." XSt C& o\ 4command you that we give up what our fathers used to worship, meaning the idols and statues. Li IS) Jjiu J jfy ior that we give up doing what we like with our property?\$ This means, "Should we abandon our practice of lightening the scales because of your statement? This is our wealth and we will do with it as we please." Al-Hasan said concerning Allah's statement, C& ol di&b iDoes your Salah command you that we give up what our fathers used to

worship,^>[1 1:87] “By Allah, this means that his prayer commanded them to abandon what their fathers used to worship.”^ * At-Thawri said concerning Allah’s statement, Li o’ jfy 4or that we give up doing what we like with our property?} “They were speaking in reference to the paying of Zakah (charity).” iVerily, you are the forbearer right-minded!} Ibn ‘Abbas, Maymun bin Mihran, Ibn Jurayj, Ibn Aslam, and Ibn Jarir all said, “These enemies of Allah were only saying this in mockery. May Allah disfigure them and curse them ll] At-Tabari 15:451.

99Surah 11. Hud (88) (Part-12) from ever receiving His mercy. And verily, He did so.” ol Oyt Lf t * liyy jji j j* fjZ Je o£" oj cJs> idt C^Ai* b> J C o', ii£ t jj 488. He said: "O my people! Tell me if I have a clear evidence from my Lord and He has given me a good sustenance from Himself (shall I corrupt it by mixing it with the unlawfully earned money). I wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you. I only desire reform to the best of my power. And my guidance cannot come except from Allah, in Him I put my trust and unto Him I repent."} Shu'ayb's Refutation of His People He said to them: Do you see O my people, that if I 4<j0 &'£>.\$} i have a clear evidence from my Lord} meaning, upon clear guidance in that which I am calling to. 4&Z% 4%} 4and He has given me a good sustenance from Himself.} It has been said that he meant the prophethood. It has also been said that he meant the lawful provisions. It seems that the verse carries both meanings. Ath-Thawri said, ihi Z j} 3 4y1 %} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you.} meaning, 'do not forbid you from something and at the same time I contradict my prohibitions in secret behind your backs, doing what I have forbidden.' This is similar to what Qatadah said concerning Allah's statement, 4& Z di 34%} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid m At-Tabari 15:453.

you .> “He is saying. I do not forbid you all from something while I do it myself.”111 \$1 only desire reform to the best of my power.} This means, “In that which I command and forbid you, I only want to correct your affair as much as I am able.” 4And my guidance cannot come This means, “In whatever I intend that agrees with the truth.” iexcept from Allah, in Him I put my trust} This means in all of my affairs. iand unto Him I repent.} meaning; “I return.” This has been said by Mujahid and others. 489. "And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you to suffer the fate similar to that of the people of Nuh or of Hiid or of Salih, and the people of Liit are not far off from you!"} 490. "And ask forgiveness of your Lord and turn unto Him in repentance. Verily, my Lord is Most Merciful, Most Loving."} He (Shu'ayb) said to them, U** pZ/k 4And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you} This means, “Do not let your hatred and enmity of me cause you to persist in your corruption and disbelief. If you continue 111 At-Tabari 15:453. 121 At-Tabari 15:454.

this way, you will suffer the same vengeance and torment that overcame Nuh's people, Hud's people, Salih's people and Lut's people.” Qatadah said, 4And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you^ “He is saying, T) do not be influenced by your differing with me.”111 As-Suddi said, “This means your enmity of me should not lead you to continue in misguidance and disbelief, or else you will be afflicted by what afflicted them.” Concerning His statement, iand the people of Liit are not far off from you!} It has been said that this refers to the period of time. Qatadah said, “This means that they were only destroyed before you yesterday.” It has also been said that it refers to place. Actually, the verse carries both meanings. 4And ask forgiveness of your Lord from the previous sins. 4and turn unto Him in repentance.} In whatever evil actions yo> may encounter in the future. Concerning his statement,

Verily, my Lord is Most Merciful Most Loving to those who repent. , Cj Afij ^ Jjrf \ ojUjj Uj of 'fL>\ 491. They said: "O Shu'ayb! We do not understand much of what you say, and we see you weak among us. Were it not for your family, you would have been stoned, and you are not m At-Tabari 15:455.

powerful against us."} 492. He said: "O my people! Is then my family of more weight with you than Allah? And you have cast Him away behind your backs. Verily, my Lord is surrounding all that you do."} The Response of Shu'ayb's People They said, <*il£ e&& 40 Shu'ayb! We do not understand} This means that we do not comprehend. 4<j^} 4much} 'most of what you say'. Ath-Thawri said, "He (Shu'ayb) was called the orator of the Prophets. [11 As-Suddi said, 4and we see you weak among us.} "They meant, You are only one person." Abu Rawq said, "They meant. You are despised, because your tribe is not upon your religion." 4Were it not for your family, you would have been stoned,} This means, your people. Were it not for their powerful position over the people of Madyan, they would have stoned him to death. Some said that this means with rocks. It has also been said that this means that they would have cursed and insulted him verbally. ^_/>» £j-L '^j} 4and you are not powerful agu.ms* us-^ This means, "You have no position of power oC'er us-" Shu'ayb's Refutation of His People 4-ii Sj 4He said: "O my people! Is then my family of more weight with you than Allah?" <t} m At-Tabari 15:458.

203 Surah 11. Hud (93-95) (Part-12) \w> Ulj 5 i \$ \$ JaL_i /> » '-' '* » ,</ -V '^ »< < — * J-* 9A-T^L- JI-Xp^rfU^^ ^ JjaA hh_3llm %te2f2ki4\ f\l s^r*"J. 'yQ&*4jy^j **> *'»)Wj*- :.1"K < \ ' - n -m? m&m \, He says: You would leave me alone out of respect for my people but not out of respect for the greatness of the Lord, the Most Blessed and Exalted? Does not your awe of Allah prevent you from harming His Prophet? Indeed you have placed the fear of Allah, 4behind your backs.\$> This means that you have thrown it behind you. You do not obey it, nor do you respect it. 4-£L^ SjLL*j KL> jj C£jfy 4Verity, my Lord is surrounding all that you do.} This means that He knows all of your actions and He will reward you according to them. ' -r* J tjL.it j4 kj>— J^lt j\ a5lC ,^t IjtLti jyCj u|Jb C*- l!2> !'ty! v^i- J >lg=>'«4 41 0-i^" j . V.k^A*^r 4 j^iulU i^jji jujl J til 4-*^ oj4 CT 1ju| >51 \i. 493 . "And O my people! Act according to your ability, and I am acting. You will come to know who it is on whom descends the torment that will cover him with ignominy, and who is a liar! And watch you! Verily, I too am watching with you."} 494. And when Our commandment came, We saved Shu'ayb

and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us . And As- Sayhah (atvful cry) seized the wrongdoers, and they lay (Jathimin) in their homes.} 495. As if they had never lived there! So away with Madyan just as Thamild went away! } Shu'ayb's threatening of His People When the Prophet of Allah, Shu'ayb, despaired of their response to him, he said, "O my people, 4Act according to your ability,} This means, "Act according to your current ways." This is actually a severe threat. 4I am acting.} according to my way. 4You will come to know who it is on whom descends the torment that will cover him with ignominy, and who is a liar!} meaning, between me and you. 4And watch you!} This means to wait. 4I too am watching with you.} Allah then says, 4And what Our commandment came, We saved Shu'ayb and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us. And As- Sayhah (awful cry) seized the wrongdoers, and they lay (Jathimin) in their homes.} His saying Jathimin means extinct and lifeless without any movement. Here Allah mentions that a loud cry (Sayhah) came to them. In Surat Al-A'raf He says a severe quake (Rajfah)

came to them. In Surat Ash-Shu'ara', He said it was a torment of a cloudy day. They were one nation upon which all of these punishments were gathered on the day of their destruction. In each context, Allah only mentioned that which was suitable. In Surat Al-A'raf when they said, ip: 4We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb, and those who have believed with you from our town.4(7:88] In this verse it was suitable to mention a tremor, or quake (Rajfah). The earth in which they practiced their wrongdoing and they wanted to expel their Prophet from it, shook them. Here, due to their disrespectful manners in speaking to their Prophet, Allah mentioned the awful cry (Sayhah) which overcame them and killed them. In Surat Ash-Shu'ara' when they said, 4 i>) <yi \ij£ l'. iSo cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!}[26\187\ Allah said in response, 0^ joj Jf .iljc pijij 4So the torment of the day of Shadow seized them . Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day.}[26:189] This is from the intricate secrets and to Allah belongs all praise and much bounty forever. Concerning the statement, 4kS3j3ai?> iAs if they had never lived there!} This means it was as if they had not lived in their homes before that. 4*a cr \z ^4 4So away with Madyan as just as Thamud went away!} They (Thamud) were their neighbors and they did not live far from the homes of the people of Madyan. They were similar in their disbelief and their highway robbery. They were also both Arabs.

107Surah 11. Hud (96-99) (Part-12) Allah also said, j& Jii , \$vj lit JUi , T> o^, Q3 4'i 4 i[4Bwf Fir'awn belied and disobeyed. Then he turned his back, striving (against Allah). Then he gathered (his people) and cried aloud. Saying: "I am your lord, most high." So Allah, seized him with exemplary punishment for his last and first transgression . Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for whosoever fears Allah.^[79:21-26] Allah also said, jjy5' J4-/J jdll fx (&) 4He will go ahead of his people on the Day of Resurrection, and will lead them into the Fire, and evil indeed is the place to which they are led.} This will be the condition of those who were followed. They will have a great share of the punishment on the Day of Resurrection. This is as Allah says, 4#^ -i Jpj JLi iFor each one there is double (torment), but you know not.} [7:38] Allah also says that the disbelievers will say while they are in the Hellfire, &&&£ C£l\ i"Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the (right) way. Our Lord! Give them double torment."} [33:67-68] Concerning the statement, iThey were pursued by a curse in this (deceiving life of this world) and (so they will be pursued by a curse) on the Day of Resurrection.} meaning, *We have made them to be followed by something more than the punishment of the Fire and that is their being cursed in this life.'

4>jC-5' %>' s*i }yj} iand on the Day of Resurrection , evil is the gift granted.} Mujahid said, "Another curse will be added to them on the Day of Resurrection, so these are two curses." 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, ievil indeed is the gift granted.} "The curse of this life and the Hereafter."*2 * Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah both said the same thing.*3 * This is similar to Allah's statement, iXLa. j d}. iid* (£&£)} <<3; p-* fyj GiK }And We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day of Resurrection, they will not be helped. And We made a curse to follow them in this world, and on the Day of Resurrection, they will be among the despised.>[28:41-42] Allah also says, > ?' 1 it? iThe Fire, they are exposed to it, morning and afternoon. And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Cause Fir'awn's people to enter the severest torment!"}[40:46] f.l& C dAj C£l/i ^ lij%\$ it 6& y.& u ilOO. That is some of the news of the (population of) towns which We relate unto you; of them, some are (still) standing, Af-Tabari 15:468. Al-Tabari 15:469. Al-Tabari 15:469, 470.

Surah VL Hud (100-101) (Part-12) 109 and some have been (already) reaped.} 4101. We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves. So their gods whom they call upon besides Allah, profited them naught when there came the command of your Lord, nor did they add aught to them but destruction .> The Lesson taken from the Destroyed Towns When Allah mentioned the story of the Prophets and what happened with them and their nations - how He destroyed the disbelievers and saved the believers - He goes on to say, \$ Stm 4That is some of the news of the (population of) towns meaning, news of them 4%p &£} iwhich We relate unto you; of them, some are (still) standing,} This means still remaining. iand some have been (already) reaped.} This means totally destroyed. 4We wronged them not,} This means, "When We destroyed them." £&j&} 4but they wronged themselves.} their rejecting their Messengers and disbelieving in them. 4So their gods, profited them [not]...} This is referring to their idols that they used to worship and invoke. io* Oi}

no Tafstr Ibn Kathir iother than Allah naughty the idols did not benefit them, nor did they save them when Allah's com- mand came for their destruction. X > i' i //V Jf- inor did they add aught to them but destruction .y Mujahid, Qatadah and others said, "This means loss. Because

the reason for their destruction and their ruin was that they followed those false gods. Therefore, they were losers in this life and the Hereafter." jiJ Ti', J±ii6Sjy >-jj o', u 4202. Such is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.y It is as though Allah is saying, "Just as We have destroyed these wicked generations who rejected their Messengers, We will do the same to any who are like them." U} iVerily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.y In the Two Sahlh's, it is recorded that Abu Musa said that the Messenger of Allah =gz said, rrr > - tf 'i ' >"?v. :r J ' .i} \ ^JU i * ' . > r > JL'u' ^ f#*- At-Tabari 15:473.

Surah TL Hud (103-105) (Part-12) 111 lij L/>- <*>* j) * Verily, Allah gives respite to a wrongdoer until He seizes him and he cannot escape .» Then the Messenger of Allah sg recited, 4*4^ J*j ii£_> Ji5 iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the towns while they are doing wrong . ,! l ft J5. feft vUi ^ Jiui 4 l\} Jir* •/*% *J ofc j£ ^ ^?>t 4:.'t '*» JUa— 4103. Indeed in that (there) is a sure lesson for those who fear the torment of the Hereafter. That is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, and that is a Day when all will be present.} 4104. And We delay it only for a term (already) fixed.} 4105. On the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah's) leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.} The Destruction of the Towns is a Proof of the Establishment of the Hour (Judgement) Allah, the Exalted, is saying that in the destruction of the disbelievers and the salvation of the believers by us is, 4'i^} 4a sure lesson}. This means an admonition and lesson concerning the truthfulness of that which We are promised in the Hereafter. }m car 4 ijx Oij^ 4Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth.^(40:51) [i| Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , and Muslim 4 :1997

112 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah, the Exalted, also says, iSo their Lord revealed to them: "Truly, We shall destroy the wrongdoers.} [14:13] Concerning Allah's statement, iThat is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, This means the first of them and the last of them. This is similar to Allah's statement, 4And We shall gather them all together so as to leave not one of them behind [18:47] iand that is a Day when all will be present.} This means a day that is great. The angels will be present, the Messengers will gather and all of the creation will be gathered with their families. The humans, Jinns,

birds, wild beasts and domesticated riding animals will all be gathered. Then the Most Just, Who does not wrong anyone even an atom's weight, will judge between them and He will increase their good deeds in reward. Concerning the statement, *And We delay it only for a term (already) fixed.* This means for a fixed period of time than cannot be increased or decreased. Then He says, *On the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah's) leave.* This means that on the Day of Judgement no one will speak except with the permission of Allah. This is similar to another verse, which says,

they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (Allah) allows, and he will speak what is right.} [78:38] Allah also says, *And all the voices will be humbled for the Most Gracious (Allah).* [20:108] In the Hadith about the intercession, which is recorded in the Two Sahihs, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *On that day except the Messengers, and the call of the Messengers will be, "O Allah, save us, save us."* Concerning Allah's statement, *Or some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.* This means that from the people of the gathering (on Judgement Day), some will be miserable and some will be happy. This is as Allah said, *When a party will be in Paradise and a party in the blazing Fire* [42:7] Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded in his Musnad on the authority of Ibn 'Umar that 'Umar said, "When this verse was revealed, some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed." I asked the Prophet ﷺ , 'O Messenger of Allah, will there be a sign for us to know (which party we are from)? Will it be because of something that a person did, or something that he did not do?' He said. *Yes.* ﷺ *Umar bin al-Faruk* Fath Al-Bari 2 :34 1 , and Muslim 1 :169

'Umar, it will be due to something that he did and the pens wrote it down. But every easy deed was created for its purpose (to be carried out) .» ,I) Then Allah explains the situation of the wretched people and the happy people. He, the Exalted, says, *As for those who are wretched, they will be in the Fire, in it they will experience Zafir and Shahiq .* 4106. As for those who are wretched, they will be in the Fire, in it they will experience Zafir and Shahiq . 4107. They will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills. Verily, your Lord is the doer of whatsoever He intends (or wills). The Condition of the Wretched People and their Destination Allah, the Exalted, says, *in it they will experience Zafir and Shahiq.* Ibn 'Abbas said, "Az-Zafir is a sound in the throat and Ash-Shahiq is a sound in the chest. This means that their exhaling will be Zafir and their inhaling will Shahiq."*2 * This will be due to the torment that they will be experiencing. We seek refuge with Allah from such evil. *They will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure,* Imam Abu Jafar bin Jarir said, "It was from the customs of the Arabs that when they wanted to describe something that would last forever, they would say, This is as enduring as the heavens and the earth.' Or, It will last as until the night and day separate.' They would say, 'As long as talkers at night continue to chat.' They meant by these statements the *It will be as enduring as the heavens and the earth.* At-Tirmidhi no. 31 1 1 Af-Tabari 15:480.

115 Surah 11. Hud (106-107) (Part-12) condition of eternity. Therefore, Allah addressed them in a manner that they were familiar with among themselves. Thus, He said, *They will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure* The literal meaning is also intended with; "for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure." This is due to the fact that there will be heavens and earth in the life of the next world, just as Allah said, *On the Day when the earth will be changed to*

another earth and so will be the heavens [14:48] For this reason, Al-Hasan Al-Basri said concerning the statement of Allah, 4the heavens and the earth endure.} “Allah is referring to a heaven other than this heaven (which we see now) and an earth other than this earth. That (new) heaven and earth will be eternal.” • Concerning Allah’s statement, 4LJ, G & %\ #j& C 4except as your Lord wills. Verily, your Lord is the doer of whatsoever He intends.} This is similar to His statement, 4The Fire be your dwelling place, you will dwell therein forever, except as Allah may will. Certainly your Lord is All- Wise, All-Knowing.} [6:128] It has been said that the exception mentioned in this verse refers to the disobedient among the people of Tawhid. It is these whom Allah will bring out of the Fire by the intercession 111 At-Jabari 15:481.

of the interceders. Those who will be allowed to intercede are the angels, the Prophets and the believers. They will intercede even on behalf of those who committed major sins. Then, the generous mercy of Allah will remove from the Fire those who have never done any good, except for saying La ilaha illatldh one day of their life. This has been mentioned in numerous authentic reports from the Messenger of Allah including narrations from Anas bin Malik, Jabir bin ‘Abdullah, Abu Sa’id Al-Khudri, Abu Hurayrah and other Companions. No one remains in the Fire after this fined intercession, except those who will remain there forever without escape. This is the opinion held by many of the scholars, both past and present, concerning the explanation of this verse. Hit U V) U IJj cyji aZ)S Jp ojji 4 J il08. And those who are blessed, they will be in Paradise, abiding therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills : a gift without an end.} The Condition of the Happy People and their Destination Allah, the Exalted, says, 'S fiat iAnd those who are blessed.} These are the followers of the Messengers. 4^they will be in Paradise,} This means that their final abode will be Paradise. jJfL} ^abiding thereinfor all the time} This means that they will remain there forever. & c vj £} 4that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills :}

117Surah 11. Hud (108) (Part-12)

The meaning of the exception that is made here is that the condition of eternal pleasure that they will experience therein is something that is not mandatory by itself. Rather, it is something that is dependent upon the will of Allah. Unto Him belongs the favor of immortality upon them. For this reason they are inspired to glorify and praise Him, just as they are inspired to breathe. 1 11 Ad-Dahhak and Al-Hasan Al-Basri both said, “It is about the right of the disobedient people of Tawhid who were in the Fire and then brought out of it.” Then Allah finished this statement by saying, 4/ft? ia gift without an end.} This means that it will never be cut off. This has been mentioned by Mujahid, Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Al- ‘Aliyah and others. ' This has been mentioned so that the suspicious person will not doubt after the mention of the will of Allah. Someone may think that the mention of Allah’s will here means that the pleasure of Paradise may end or change. To the contrary, it has been decreed that this pleasure will truly be forever and will never end. Likewise, Allah has clarified here that the eternal torment of the people of the Fire in Hell also is due to His will. He explains that He punishes them due to His justness and wisdom. This is why He says, ^Verily, your Lord is the doer ofwhatsoever He intends.} Similarly, Allah says, il (Uj ji? ft 4He cannot be questioned as to what He does, while they will be questioned.>[21 :23] Here, Allah soothes the hearts and affirms the intent, by His saying, 4/ft? ivLft 4a gift without an end.} It has been recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger ofAllah jg said. 111 Muslim 4:2181. AMabari 15:490.

>>- <-> - MT>|' ij5 tf; id </ cri^ SJ.t-*' »jj 'r'jAJL. u'ji cjiiii^ aUJi is£& £ul ?U !&jl Jif U :Jli;^i !jlljl Uj «o^> •Death will be brought in the farm of a hand- some ram (on the Day of Judgement) and it will be slaughtered between Paradise and the Hellfire. Then, it will be said, “O people of Paradise! Eter- nity and no death! O people of Hellfire! Eter- nity and no death!”tll] In the Safylfy it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg\$ said, l\ !<yi Jil U :JUjb «*,,* t ** * * * s i ixi i^Xju ji jl t)jj i Ixl —i lj~>t />* t)l OJj t ixl \j*j4j 1j. .j.j l)1 Oij «ix'l £ «Jf u>i// fee said, ‘O people of Paradise, verily you will live and you will never die. You will remain young and you will never grow old. You will remain healthy and you will never become ill. You will be happy and you will never grieve . |2’ 12] Jj Ji pASVj’* -*r“. w*» j| ujxw-j u t>jy* ^ju cj o*» jay Ji *-^6 v^£=»i’ t?’* AjJJ Jj (4^0 & yf Qj Q Jf ftf (»t? >%3 ojd? Fath Al-B&ri 8 :282 , and Muslim 4 :2188 Muslim 4:2182.

4%j^- 4109. So be not in doubt as to what these people (pagans and polytheists) worship. They worship nothing but what their fathers worshipped before (them). And verily, We shall repay them in full their portion without diminution.} 4110. Indeed, We gave the Book to Musa, but differences arose therein, and had it not been for a Word that had gone forth before from your Lord, the case would have been judged between them, and indeed they are in grave doubt concerning it (this Qur'an).} 4111. And verily, to each of them your Lord will repay their works in full. Surely, He is All-Aware of what they do.} Associating Partners with Allah is no doubt Misguidance Allah, the Exalted, says, 4X& zz IL: j,£%} 4So be not in doubt as to what these people worship.} This refers to the polytheists. Verily, what they are doing is falsehood, ignorance and misguidance. Verily, they are only worshipping what their fathers worshipped before. This means that they have no support for their Shirk. They are only mimicking their fathers in ignorance. Therefore, Allah will give them due recompense for that and He will punish them with a punishment the likes of which none can give besides Him. If they did any good deeds, then Allah will reward them for those good works in this life, before the life of the Hereafter. Concerning Allah’s statement, JL "V 4And verily, We shall repay them in full their portion without diminution.} ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “We will pay them in full their portion of punishment without diminution.”l 11 Then, Allah mentions that He gave Mtisa the Book, but the people |i| At-Tabari 15:492.

differed concerning it. Some believed in it and some disbelieved in it. Therefore, you, Muhammad, have an example in the Prophets who came before you. So do not grieve or be upset by their denial of you. ‘J ot y&} iand had it not been for a Word [Kalitnah] that had gone forth before from your Lord, the case would have been judged between them,} Ibn Jarir said, “If it were not that the punishment had already been delayed until an appointed time, then Allah would have decided the matter between you now. The word Kalimah carries the meaning that Allah will not punish anyone until the proof has been established against him and a Messenger has been sent to him.”111 This is similar to Allah’s statement, iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).} (17: 15] For verily, Allah says in another verse, C Jfjfc j3j 0& Jtjo.c& 4 «&> 4And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined, (their punishment) must necessarily have come (in this world). So bear patiently what they say.}[20:129-130] Then, Allah informs that He will gather the early generations and the later generations from all of the nations. He will then reward them based upon their deeds. If they did good deeds, their reward will be good, and if they did evil deeds, their reward will be bad. Allah says, oJL*; Ui lily & yf op} 4And verily, to each of them your Lord will repay their works in

full. Surely, He is All-Aware of what they do.) This means that He is All-Knower of all of their deeds. This includes their honorable deeds and their despicable deeds. m At-Tabari 15:493.

their small deeds and their great deeds. There are many different modes of recitation for this verse, yet all of their meanings agree with what we have mentioned. This is similar to Allah's statement, 4#^ £5 y-. 6%o0)And surely, all - everyone of them will be brought before lis.M36:321 Ji v; kl% ££ •*; c, V j13 ,v ojj (V l*. ,t'^ tr 4312. So stand (ask Allah to make) you firm and straight as you are commanded and those who him in repentance with you, and transgress not. Verily, He is All-Seer of what you do.) 4313. And incline not toward those who do wrong, lest the Fire should touch you, and you have no protectors other than Allah, nor would you then be helped.) TheCommand to Stand Firm and Straight Allah, the Exalted, commands His Messenger jfa, and His believing servants to be firm and to always be upright. This is of the greatest aid for gaining victory over the enemy and confronting the opposition. Allah also forbids transgression, which is to exceed the bounds (of what is allowed). Verily, transgression causes destruction to its practitioner, even if the transgression was directed against a polytheist. Then, Allah informs that He is All-Seer of the actions of His servants. He is not unaware of anything and nothing is hidden from Him. Concerning Allah's statement, 4i£i 'M JI iAnd incline not toward those who do wrong,) 'AH bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Do not compromise with them." Ibn Jarir said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Do not side with those who do wrong. ",I1 This is a good statement. This means, "Do not seek assistance from m At-Jabari 15:501.

Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and others said, "This means the night prayer ('Ishd)." Ibn Al-Mubarak reported from Mubarak bin Fadalal that Al-Hasan said, iand in some hours of the night. "This means the evening (Maghrib and late night ("Ishd) prayers. The Messenger of Allah jg said, ojLLJlj :jdll UJj lli» *They are the approach of the night: Maghrib and 'Isha' The same was said by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak (that this means the Maghrib and 'Isha' prayers). It should be noted that this verse was revealed before the five daily prayers were made obligatory during the night of Isr&' (the Prophet's night journey to Jerusalem). At that time there were only two obligatory prayers: a prayer before sunrise and a prayer before sunset. During the late night another prayer (Tahajjud) was also made obligatory upon the Prophet jg and his nation. Later, this obligation was abrogated for his nation and remained obligatory upon him jg. Finally, this obligation was abrogated for the Prophet jg as well, according to one opinion. Allah knows best. The Good Deeds wipe away the Evil Deeds Concerning Allah's statement, iVerily, the good deeds remove the evil deeds . This is saying that the performance of good deeds is an expiation of previous sins. This has been mentioned in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad and the Sunan Compilers, that the Commander of the faithful, 'Ali bin Abi Talib, said, "Whenever I used to hear a narration from the Messenger of Allah (jg), Allah would cause me to benefit by it however He willed. If anyone informed me of any statement that he said, I would make him swear (by Allah) that the Prophet jg said it. If he swore by Allah, then I would believe him. Abu Bakr once told me - and Abu Bakr was truthful - that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say,

«J 'jm. & J_;jJ j4ii^ u» "There is not any Muslim who commits a sin, then he makes Wudu' and prays two units of prayer, except that he will be forgiven (that sin) .»,xl In the Two Sahths it is recorded that the Commander of the faithful, TJthman bin 'Affan made Wudu' for the people (to see), just like the

Wudu' of the Messenger of Allah Then he said, "I saw the Messenger of Allah & make Wudu' like this, and he jgg said, U aJ 'jif- U*j «4ji "Whoever makes Wudu' like this Wudu' of mine, then he prays two units of prayer in which he does not speak to himself, he will be forgiven for his previous sins. In the SaMi it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah \$5 said, "Do you think that if there was a flowing river at the door of anyone of you and he bathed in it five times every day, would there be any dirt left on him? They said, "No, O Messenger of Allah!" He (^) said; oIjLaII "This is like the five daily prayers, for Allah uses them to wipe away the sins and wrongdoings .»*31 Muslim recorded in his Sahih that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg used to say, UJ olyiSU t jlXtjj lixljl Jj Ul Ahmad 1:9, Abu Dawud 2:180, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:357, An-NasSt in Al-Kubra 6 : 109 and Ibn Majah 1 :446 121 FathAl-B&ri 1 :320, Muslim 1 :260. Al-Bukhari no. 527, and Muslim no. 667.

Surah VL Hud (114-115) (Part-12). 125 aThe five daily prayers, Jumu'ah (Friday prayer) to Jumu'ah and (the fast of) Ramadan to Ramadan are expiations for whatever sins were committed between them, as long as you stay away from the major sins. Al-Bukhari recorded Ibn MasTid saying that a man kissed a woman (who was not his relative or wife). He then came to the Prophet and informed him about the incident. Thus, Allah revealed, ' ./ /• •> 4And perform Salah, at the two ends of the day and in some hours of the night. Verily, the good deeds remove the evil deeds.}[11:114] The man then said, "O Messenger of Allah, is this only for me?" The Prophet 5% replied, «This is for all of my (Ummah) followers .»(2' Al-Bukhari recorded this narration in the Book of Prayer as well and the Book of TafsirP Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that a man came to TJmar and said that a woman came to do business with him. During the course of their business, he took her into his place and did everything with her except the actual act of sexual intercourse. TJmar said, "Woe unto you! She probably was a woman whose husband is away (fighting) in the path of Allah." The man said, "Of course she was." TJmar then said, "Go to Abu Bakr and ask him about this." The man went to Abu Bakr and asked him about the matter. Abu Bakr said, "She probably was a woman whose husband is away (fighting) in the path of Allah," just as TJmar had said. Then he went to the Prophet sg and told him the same story. The Prophet said, •jiil Jr- J! Vrf- I 1 ' Muslim 1 :209. 121 Path Al-Bari 2:12. |3) Fath Al-Bari 7 :206.

iShe probably was a woman whose husband is away (fighting) in the path of Allah. Then a verse of Qur'an was revealed, ky& iAnd perform the Saldh, at the two ends of the day and in some hours of the night. Verily, the good deeds remove the evil deeds.} The man then said, "O Messenger of Allah! Is this verse only for me, or does it apply to all of the people in general?" Umar then struck the man on his chest with his hand and said, "No, rather it is for all of the people in general." Then the Messenger of Allah said, .»' - ' , . 'jaS' «'Umar has spoken the truth .s1 * 1 U 4 *0*1£ iSJSk%\$ Oi oiiifUX ><£=* c % % \j>J\ t rffSvrLL I *' \A± it. v-ttT 4116. If only there had been among the generations before you persons having wisdom, prohibiting (others) from Fasad (corruption) in the earth, except a few of those whom We saved from among them! Those who did wrong pursued the enjoyment of good things of (this worldly) life, and were criminals.} 4117. And your Lord would never destroy the towns wrongfully, while their people were doers of good.} There must be a Group of People Who forbid Lewdness Allah, the Exalted, says that there should have been a group of wise people present among the past generations who called to good and forbade the evil and corruption that took place among them in the land. His statement, m Ahmad 1 :245 4 'M 'ffr

except a few} This means that there were only a small number of people present among them who were of this caliber. They were those whom Allah saved at the sudden striking of His vengeance, when His anger was let loose. For this reason Allah commanded this noble Ummah (followers of Muhammad ﷺ) to always have among them those who command the good and forbid the evil. This is as Allah says, *Let there arise out of you a group of people inviting to all that is good, enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. And it is they who are the successful.* [3:104] It is related in a Hadith that the Prophet ﷺ said, *Verily, whenever a group of people see an evil and they do not change it, it is likely that Allah will cover them with (His) punishment.* Thus, Allah says, *And if only there had been among the generations before you persons having wisdom, prohibiting (others) from the transgression in the earth, - except a few of those whom We saved from among them!* Concerning the statement, *Those who did wrong pursued the enjoyment of good things of (this worldly) life,* This means that they continued in their ways of disobedience and evils and they did not heed the protesting of those righteous people, until the torment suddenly seized them. 111 Ibn Majah 2 :1327.

And were criminals. *And your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) servants.* [41:46] *And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree.* Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy, and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (His saying): *"Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."* Allah has not made Faith universally accepted Allah, the Exalted, informs that He is able to make all of mankind one nation upon belief, or disbelief. This is just as He said,

129 Surah VL Hud (118-119) (Part-12 OfjVf 4 '(jft 4 And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. (10:99] Allah goes on to say, *O' People! they will not cease to disagree. Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy,*) This means that people will always differ in religions, creeds, beliefs, opinions and sects. Concerning Allah's statement, *Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy,*) This means that those who have received the mercy of Allah by following the Messengers are excluded from this. They are those who adhere to what they are commanded in the religion by the Messengers of Allah. That has always been their characteristic until the coming of the finality of the Prophets and Messengers (Muhammad ﷺ). Those who received Allah's mercy are those who followed him, believed in him and supported him. Therefore, they succeeded by achieving happiness in this life and the Hereafter. They are the Saved Sect mentioned in the Hadith recorded in the Musnad and Sunan collections of Hadith. The routes of transmission of this Hadith all strengthen each other (in authenticity). In these narrations the Prophet ﷺ said, *Verily, the Jews split into seventy-one sects, and the Christians split into seventy-two sects, and this nation (of Muslims) will split into seventy-three sects. All of them will be in the Fire*

except one sectj They (the Companions) said, “Who are they (the Saved Sect) OMessenger of Allah?” He said,

230 Tafstr Ibn Kathir lit U& «77ie sect that is upon what my Companions and I are uponj111 Al-Hakim recorded this narration in his Mustadrak with this additional wording. [2] Concerning Allah’s statement, iAnd the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (His saying) "Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."^ Allah, the Exalted, informs that He precedes everything in His preordainment and decree, by His perfect knowledge and penetrating wisdom. The result of this decree is that from those whom He has created, some deserve the Paradise and some deserve the Hell Fire. From this decree is that He will fill the Hellfire with both mankind and Jinns. His is the profound evidence and the perfect wisdom. In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, Ulij, Jj-'X, 'i J U :&fji oJU i j0IJ jAj U ; -u i jul ofj : jil'i cJu; :-L litil fX* ^l-U oJI ! jillJ JI5j i«Lil ^ ktii i >—j' uj <jjl «^ ^~4- U-4J 1 U li i UyJU i)Qj \y\c. juy. ;3 *ij JljJ j lli 1 Ui_» UJb^ s,iljypj laJ Jji : Jyd Ujii Sy»Jl Uj'j «Paradise and the Hellfire debated. Paradise said, 'None will enter me except the zvcak and despised of the people.' The Hell- fire said, 'I have inherited the haughty and the arrogant people.' Then Allah said to the Paradise, 'You are My mercy and I grant mercy with you to ivhoever I wish.' Then He said to the Hellfire, 'You are My torment and I take vengeance with you h' Ahmad 2:332, Abu Dawud 5:4, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :397 and Ibn Majah 2:1322. 121 Al-Hakim 1 :129.

Sitrah 11 , H d (120) (Part-12) 232 upon whoever I wish. I will fill each one of you.' However, the Paradise will always have more bounties, to such an extent that Allah will create more creatures to dwell in it and enjoy its extra bounties. The Hellfire will continue saying, 'Are there anymore (to enter me),' until the Lord of might places His Foot over it. Then it (Hell) will say, "Enough, enough, bu Your might!" 4120. And all that We relate to you of the news of the Messengers is in order that We may make strong andfirm your heart thereby. And in this has come to you the truth, as ivell as an admonition and a reminderfor the believers The Conclusion Allali, the Exalted, is saying, “We relate all of these stories to you (Muhammad) concerning what happened with the Messengers who came before you with their nations. This is an explanation of what transpired in their arguments and disputes and how the Prophets were all rejected and harmed.These stories also explain how Allah helped His party of believers and disgraced His enemies, the disbelievers. We relate all of this to you (Muhammad) in order to make your heart firm and so that you may take an example from your brothers who passed before you of the Messengers.’ Concerning Allah’s statement, 4And in this has come to you the truth, This is referring to this Surah itself. This was said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and a group of the Salaf and it is the correct view. This means, This comprehensive Sarah contains the stories of the Prophets and how Allah saved them, and the believers along with them and how He destroyed the disbelievers. There has come to you (Muhammad) stories of Fath Al-Bari 13 :444 and Muslim 4 :2186.

unseen of the heavens and the earth and that unto Him is the final return. He explains that everyone who does a deed. He will give them their deed (reward for it) on the Day of Reckoning. Unto Him belongs the creation and the command. Then He, the Exalted, commands that He should be worshipped and relied upon, for verily, He is sufficient for whoever trusts and turns to Him. Concerning His statement, u* diZj }And your Lord is not unaware ofwhat you do.} This means, The lies (of the disbeliever^) against you OMuhammad are not hidden from Him. He is the All-Knower of the

conditions of His creatures and He will give them the getfeot ^ocopipwrte for tlmTr ,*fc»5ds in.£tt» Hfe aqd the Hfieaffoi. Wle wilLaadynu iflikd) and phrty over the disbelievers in this life and in the Hereafter.’

Surah 12: Yusuf

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2674]

Opening The Tafstr of Surah Yusuf (Chapter - 12)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2674–2722]

-Sg» In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, ijaju ^ ^-L«J l^X Ol»l* Aty Cjt :a oij .J-iJ' lx!* LJ*>.y tj ,j^~l «itllx 41. Alif-Ldm-Rd. These are the verses of the Book that is clear.} 42. Verily, We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'an in order that you may understand .} 43. We relate unto you the best of stories through Our revelations unto you, of this Qur'an. And before this, you were among those who kneio nothing about it.} Qualities ofthe Qur'an In the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah we talked about the separate letters, Allah said, 0*1* ^ 4These are the verses of the Book} in reference to the Clear Qur'an that is plain and apparent, and explains, clarifies and makes known the unclear matters. Allah said next, T b*^x 4Verily, I've have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'an in order that you may understand.} The Arabic language is the most eloquent, plain, deep and expressive of the meanings that might arise in one's mind. Therefore, the most honorable Book, was revealed in the most

135SUrak 12. Yusuf (1-3) (Part-12) honorable language, to the most honorable Prophet and Messenger sfe, delivered by the most honorable angel, in the most honorable land on earth, and its revelation started during the most honorable month of the year, Ramadan. Therefore, the Qur'an is perfect in every respect. So Allah said, Lo AWe relate unto you the best of stories through Our revelations unto you, of this Qur'mt.} Reasonbehind revealingAyah (12:3) On the reason behind revealing Ayah (12:3), Ibn Jarir At- Tabari recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said, "They said, '6, Allah's Messenger! Why not narrate to us stories?' 1" Later on, this Ayah was revealed, J vitu "(I've relate unto you the best ofstories . . ,*"121 There is a Hadith that is relevant upon mentioning this honorable Ayah, which praises the Qur'an and demonstrates that it is sufficient from needing all books besides it. Imam Ahmad recorded a narration from Jabir bin 'Abdullah that 'Umar bin Al-Khattab came to the Prophet sg with a book that he took from some of the People of the Book. 'Umar began reading it to the Prophet sg, who became angry. He said, -Jl U UJ j S'uiM err*" i -0alii JLU, \ i aj JjSci ji- jji S\l3 'j u j\< ji 4 1Arc you uncertain about it Ibn AI-Khattab? By the One in Whose Hand is my soul! I have come to you with it white and pure. Do not ask them about anything, for they might tell you something true and you reject it, or they might tell you something false and you believe it. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul! If

Musa were living, he would have no choice but i 1 About nations that have passed, how they answered their Prophets, what happened to them afterwards , etc I2i At-Tabari 15:552.

236 Tafstr Ibn Kathir to follow me. s' Imam Ahmad also recorded a narration from 'Abdullah bin Thabit who said, "Umar came to Allah's Messenger jg and said; 'O Messenger of Allah! I passed by a brother of mine from [the tribe of] Qurayzah, so he wrote some comprehensive statements from the Tawrah for me, should I read them to you?' The face of Allah's Messenger changed [with anger]. So I said to him, Don't you see the face of Allah's Messenger?" TJmar said, *We are pleased with Allah as our Lord, Islam as our religion, and Muhammad as our Messenger.' So the anger of the Prophet sg subsided, and he said. »dLaJ jjj y* C*-* f ^ t oJUj 'o=r ^ 1 Iri ti'j yt J** - the One in Whose Hand is Mufiammad's soul, if Musa appeared among you and you were to follow him, abandoning me, then you would have strayed. Indeed you are my share of the nations, and I am your slwre of the Prophets. a**21 4 pif; 44. (Remember) when Yusuf said to his father: "O my father! Verily, I saw (in a dream) eleven stars and the sun and the moon - I saw them prostrating themselves to me."\$ Yusuf's Dream Allah says, 'Mention to your people, O Muhammad, among the stories that you narrate to them, the stoiy of Yusuf.' Prophet YQsuf (Joseph) mentioned his dream to his father, Prophet Ya'qub (Jacob), son of Prophet Ishaq (Isaac), son of Prophet Ibrahim (Abraham), peace be upon them all. 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas stated that the dreams of Prophets are revelations from Allah.*3 ' Scholars of Tafsir explained that in Yusuf's dream the eleven stars represent his brothers, who were 111 Ahmad 3 :387 Ahmad 4:266. See Al-Irwa'no. 1589. 131 At-Tabari 15:554.

137 Surah 12. Yusuf (4-5) (Part-12) eleven, and the sun and the moon represent his father and mother. This explanation was collected from Ibn 'Abbas, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah, Sufyan Ath-Thawri and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Yusuf's vision became a reality forty years later, or as some say, eighty years, when Yusuf raised his parents to the throne while his brothers were before him. 4 Vi*- J* , 3t» <j£ Cri*J Jt'J* J'b A iand they fell down before him prostrate. And he said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My Lord has made it come true!"} [I] % Si "<£ J \ji£ &m S'X Y 45. He (the father) said: "O my son! Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they should arrange a plot against you. Verily, Shaytdn is to man an open enemy!"} Ya'qub orders Yusuf to hide His Vision to avoid Shaytan's Plots Allah narrates the reply Ya'qQb gave his son Yusuf when he narrated to him the vision that he saw, which indicated that his brothers would be under his authority. They would be subjugated to Yusuf's authority to such an extent that they would prostrate before him in respect, honor and appreciation. Ya'qub feared that if Yusuf narrated his vision to any of his brothers, they would envy him and conspire evil plots against him. This is why Ya'qub said to YQsuf, 4'^T 4Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they should arrange a plot against you.} This Ayah means, "They might arrange a plot against you that causes your demise." In the Sunnah, there is a confirmed Hadith that states, ' At-Tabari 15:557.

138 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Vj i l j i SjLLJ J* l ,4Yl 'fcjjii LfiU »//fl«i/ of you saw a vision that he likes, let him narrate it. If he saiv a dream that he dislikes, let him turn on his other side, blow to his left thrice, seek refuge with Allah from its evil and not tell it to anyone. Verily, it will not harm him in this case.»111 In another Hadith that Imam Ahmad and collectors of the Sunan collected, Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al-Qushayri said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, '—'jre' lip ' l* jib I "The dream is tied to

a bird's leg, as long as it is not interpreted. If it is interpreted, it comes true.»¹²¹ Therefore, one should hide the prospects or the coming of a bounty until it comes into existence and becomes known. The Prophet said, I— iji fS jp i elSai "Earn help for fulfilling needs by being discrete, for every owner of a blessing is envied. JI* ifj Jup; at iaQuj eTJ f jLic. liUj 0^ Jj at Qy]& ET i6. "Thus will your Lord choose you and teach you the interpretation of dreams (and other things) and perfect His favor on you and on the offspring of Ya'qub, as He perfected it on your fathers, Ibrahim and Ishaq aforetime! Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise."} Interpretation of Yusuf's Vision Allah says that Ya'qub said to his son Yusuf, 'Just as Allah chose you to see the eleven stars, the sun and the moon 111 Muslim 4:1772. Ahmad 4 :10, Abu Dawud 5 :283 Ibn Majah 2 :1288. At-Tabari 20:94.

iThus will your Lord choose you? designate and assign you to be a Prophet from Him, {and teach you the interpretation of Ahadith'?.} Mujahid and several other scholars said that this part of the Ayah is in reference to the interpreting of dreams. ' He said next, {and perfect His favor on you'?, 'by His Message and revelation to you.' This is why Ya'qub said afterwards, {as He perfected it aforetime on your fathers, Ibrahim...?, Allah's intimate friend, ie&ljf {and Ishaq?, Ibrahim's son, {Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise.? Allah knows best whom to choose for His Messages. jEj jtif lj>jl jl '-Ly. A ij} i>l t XLAc. (jA Hi bJj 4 LjLy ijiiij jffi jli ', Cj **JU; J* VffhA'j j^C.1 iZjj ^ ' oi 47 . Verily, in Yusuf and his brethren there were Ayat for those who ask. 48. When they said: "Truly, Yusuf and his brother are dearer, to our father than we, while we are 'Usbah (a group). Really) our father is in a plain error."} 49. "Kill Yusuf or cast him out to some (other) land, so that At-Jabari 15:560.

the favor of your father may be given to you alone, and after that you will be righteous folk."} iLO. One from among them said: "Kill not Yusuf, but if you must do something, throw him down to the bottom of a well; he will be picked up by some caravan of travelers."} There are Lessons to draw from the Story of Yusuf Allah says that there are Ayat, lessons and wisdom to learn from the story of Yusuf and his brothers, for those who ask about their story and seek its knowledge. Surely, their story is unique and is worthy of being narrated. 4*5) ill v*J yu iWhen they said: "Truly, Yusuf and his brother are dearer to our father than we..."} They swore, according to their false thoughts, that Yusuf and his brother Binyamin (Benjamin), Yusuf's full brother, 4'<LE& \L G3 i dearer to our father than we, while we are 'Usbah.} meaning, a group. Therefore, they thought, how can he love these two more than the group, J l[] iReally, our father is in a plain error.} because he preferred them and loved them more than us. ife '4-JP&aV& }^ 4Kill Yusuf or cast him out to some (other) land, so that the favor of your father may be given to you alone,} They said, 'Remove Yusuf, who competes with you for your father's love, from in front of your father's face so that his favor is yours alone. Either kill Yusuf or banish him to a distant land so that you are rid of his trouble and you alone enjoy the love of your father.' iand after that you will be righteous folk.}, thus intending repentance before committing the sin,

141 Surah 12. Yusuf (7-10) (Part-12) 33» ti} 40ne from among them said...} Qatadah and Muhammad bin Ishaq said that he was the oldest among them and his name was Ruben (Reuben). 11 ' As- Suddi said that his name was Yahudha (Judah). Mujahid said that it was Shamti (Simeon) who said, 4K.Hl not Yusuf,}, do not let your enmity and hatred towards him reach this level, of murder. However, their plot to kill Yusuf would not have succeeded, because Allah the Exalted willed that Yusuf fulfill a mission that must be fulfilled and complete; he would receive Allah's revelation and become His Prophet. Allah

willed Yusuf to be a powerful man in Egypt and govern it. Consequently, Allah did not allow them to persist in their intent against Yusuf, through Rubll's words and his advice to them that if they must do something, they should throw him down to the bottom of a well, where he will be picked up by some caravan of travelers passing by. This way, he said, you will rid yourselves of this bother without having to kill him, if you must do something, meaning, if you still insist on getting rid of him. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, "They agreed to a particularly vicious crime that involved cutting the relation of the womb, undutiful treatment of parents, and harshness towards the young, helpless and sinless. It was also harsh towards the old and Ayeak who have the rights of being respected, honored and appreciated, as well as, being honored with Allah and having parental rights on their offspring. They sought to separate the beloved father, who had reached old age and his bones became weak, yet had a high status with Allah, from his beloved young son, in spite of his weakness, tender age and his need of his 111 At-Tabari 15:564-565.

J iiSSil- rri tSsijiNS, father's compassion -• < > > • > I? ijllj ij, Q\jl5iloolt !#>\$ Jjjijli^ js*ajjd i0o0> >.S'\ >y:'.\ *>*J[', ', '<&*' \ . "'r J1S jjJailsJ and kindness. May Allah forgive them, and indeed. He is the Most Merciful among those who have mercy, for they intended to carry out a "grave error." Ibn Abi Hatim collected this state- ment, from the route of Salamah bin Al-Fadl from Muhammad bin Ishaq. ol* \j\j V liU L litis * V • 'j' I Ilj i & iis 12; jj-ji V /) tyj ill. They said: "O our father! Why do you not trust us with Yusuf though we are indeed his well-wishers?"} il2. "Send him with us tomorrow to enjoy himself and play, and verily, we will take care of him."} Yusuf's Brothers ask for Their Father's Permission to take Yusuf with Them When Yusuf's brothers agreed to take him and throw him down the well, taking the advice of their elder brother Rubll, they went to their father Ya'qub, peace be upon him. They said to him, "Why is it that you, 4\$0_j>w£j Jj Cjj iJu*y jc bslj ^} do not trust us with Yusuf though we are indeed his well- wishers?}." They started executing their plan by this introductory

143 Surah 12. Yusuf (13-14) (Part-12) statement, even though they really intended its opposite, out of envy towards Yusuf for being loved by his father. They said, "iSend him with us) tomorrow so that we all enjoy ourselves and play." Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said similarly.*21 Yusuf's brothers said next, ii iand verily, we ivill take care of him.), we will protect him and ensure his safety for you. 'w'cSyUii il* >jilj o' ijU-lj .jj 0* ^ jli i f <>\ J[4ijJI ^ ijtf 413. He (Ya'qub) said: "Truly, it saddens me that you should take him away. 1 fear lest a wolf should devour him, while you are careless of him.") 414. They said : "If a wolf devours him, while ive are 'Usbah (a group), then surely, we arc the losers.") Ya'qub's Answer to Their Request Allah narrates to us that His Prophet Ya'qub said to his children, in response to their request that he send Yusuf with them to the desert to tend their cattle, iTruly, it saddens me that you should take him away.) He said that it was hard on him that he be separated from Yusuf for the duration of their trip, until they came back. This demonstrates the deep love that Ya'qub had for his json, because he saw in Yusuf great goodness and exalted qualities with regards to conduct and physical attractiveness associated with the rank of prophethood. May Allah's peace and blessings be on him. Prophet Ya'qub's statement next, 111 At-Tabari 15:570. 121 At-Tabari 15:571.

\$1 fear lest a wolf should devour him, while you are careless of him.} He said to them, 1 fear that you might be careless with him while you are tending the cattle and shooting, then a wolf might come and eat him while you are unaware.' They heard these words from his mouth and used them in their

response for what they did afterwards. They also gave a spontaneous reply for their father's statement, saying, 4o_J!y—1»J i. 0>Oj v-jJI ilf a wolf devours him, while we are an 'Usbah, then surely, we are the losers.} They said, "If a wolf should attack and devour him while we are all around him in a strong group, then indeed we are the losers and weak.' to hA&& *4 & •A-f. O',1 £*!; 'H I*- 415. So, when they took him away, they all agreed to throw him down to the bottom of the well, and We revealed to him "Indeed, you shall (one day) inform them of this their affair, when they know (you) not."} Yusuf is thrown in a Well Allah says that when Yusuf's brothers took him from his father, after they requested him to permit that, <4 J \yj?lj} 4they all agreed to throw him down to the bottom of the well,} This part of the Ayah magnifies their crime, in that it mentions that they all agreed to throw him to the bottom of the well. This was their intent, yet when they took him from his father, they pretended otherwise, so that his father sends him with a good heart and feeling at ease and comfortable with his decision. It was reported that Ya'qQb, peace be upon him, embraced Yusuf, kissed him and supplicated to Allah for him when he sent him with his brothers. As-Suddi said that the time spent between pretending to be well-wishers and harming Yusuf was no longer than their straying far from their

145 Surah 12. Yusuf (16-18) (Part-12 father's eyes. They then started abusing Yusuf verbally, by cursing, and harming him by beating. When they reached the well that they agreed to throw him in, they tied him with rope and lowered him down. When Yusuf would beg one of them, he would smack and curse him. When he tried to hold to the sides of the well, they struck his hand and then cut the rope when he was only half the distance from the bottom of the well. He fell into the water and was submerged. However, he was able to ascend a stone that was in the well and stood on it.' Allah said next, iand We revealed to him : "Indeed, you shall (one day) inform them of this their affair, when they know (you) not."} In this Ayah, Allah mentions His mercy and compassion and His compensation and relief that He sends in times of distress. Allah revealed to Yusuf, during that distressful time, in order to comfort his heart and strengthen his resolve, TDo not be saddened by what you have suffered. Surely, you will have a way out of this distress and a good end, for Allah will aid you against them, elevate your rank and raise your grade. Later on, you will remind them of what they did to you,' {when they know not.} "Ibn 'Abbas commented on this Ayah, "You will remind them of this evil action against you, while they are unaware of your identity and unable to recognize you."*2 JI'vCMAL-* lli==> jij Li Lj 4 £ «£ \$6If 1>\ pZ\p c#: \$ jg 416. And they came to their father in the early part of the night weeping.} 417. They said: "O our father! We were racing with one another, and left Yusuf by our belongings and a wolf devoured At-Jabari 15:574. At-Jabari 15:577.

IM. Tafsir Ibn Kathir him; but you will never believe us even when we speak the truth."} 418. And they brought his shirt stained with false blood. He said: "Nay, but your own selves have made up a tale. So (for me) patience is most fitting. And it is Allah (Alone) Whose help can be sought against that (lie) which you describe."} Yusuf's Brothers try to deceive Their Father Allah narrates to us the deceit that Yusuf's brothers resorted to, after they threw him to the bottom of the well. They went back to their father, during the darkness of the night, crying and showing sorrow and grief for losing Yusuf. They started giving excuses to their father for what happened to Yusuf, falsely claiming that, 4We went racing with one another}, or had a shooting competition, 1 ^ '.jj } 4and left Yusuf by our belongings}, guarding our clothes and luggage, ibx teJz} iand a wolf devoured him}, which is exactly what their father told them he feared for Yusuf and warned against. They said next, U (Vil*-* oil }but you will

never believe us even when we speak the truth.} They tried to lessen the impact of the grave news they were delivering. They said, "We know that you will not believe this news, even if you consider us truthful. So what about when you suspect that we are not truthful, especially since you feared that the wolf might devour Yusuf and that is what happened?" Therefore, they said, 'You have reason not to believe us because of the strange coincidence and the amazing occurrence that happened to us.' & j%-j} 4Atid they brought his shirt stained with false blood.}

on it, to help prove plot that they all agreed on. They slaughtered a sheep, according to Mujahid, As-Suddi and several other scholars, and stained Yusuf's shirt with its blood. ' They claimed that this was the shirt Yusuf was wearing when the wolf devoured him, being stained with his blood. But, they forgot to tear the shirt, and this is why Allah's Prophet Ya'qub did not believe them. Rather, he told them what he felt about what they said to him, thus refusing their false claim, iUr^ (A PEE j:> 4Nay, but your own selves have made up a tale. So (for me) patience is most fitting. Ya'qub said, 'I will firmly observe patience for this plot on which you agreed, until Allah relieves the distress with His aid and compassion, i'ofifi £& iAtid it is Allah (alone) Whose help can be sought against that which you describe. K against the lies and unbelievable incident that you said had occurred.' 1 * t" * "li " > 419. And there came a caravan of travelers and they sent their water-drawer, and he let down his bucket (into the well). He said: "What good news! Here is a boy." So they hid him as merchandise (a slave). And Allah was the All-Knower of what they did.)> 420. And they sold him for a Bakhs price, -for a few Dirhams. And they were of those who regarded him insignificant. \$ Yusuf is Rescued from the Well and sold as a Slave Allah narrates what happened to Yusuf, peace be upon him, after his brothers threw him down the well and left him in it, alone, where he remained for three days, according to Adu Bakr bin 'Ayyash. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "After Yusuf's m At-Tabari 15:580.

148 Tafstr Ibn Kathir brothers threw him down the well, they remained around the well for the rest of the day to see what he might do and what would happen to him. Allah sent a caravan of travelers that camped near that well, and they sent to it the man responsible for drawing water for them. When he approached the well, he lowered his bucket down into it, Yusuf held on to it and the man rescued him and felt happy, 4"What good news! Here is a boy."} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented, "Allah's statement, 4So they hid him as merchandise}, is in reference to Yusuf's brothers, who hid the news that he was their brother. Yusuf hid this news for fear that his brothers might kill him and preferred to be sold instead. Consequently, Yusuf's brothers told the water drawer about him and that man said to his companions, 4"What good news! Here is a boy."}, a slave whom we can sell. Therefore, Yusuf's own brothers sold him." Allah's statement, 4&1C Zg%} 4And Allah was the All-Knower of what they did.} states that Allah knew what Yusuf's brothers, and those who bought him, did. He was able to stop them and prevent them from committing their actions, but out of His perfect wisdom He decreed otherwise. He let them do what they did, so that His decision prevails and His appointed destiny rules, 45hU&3f&Sm 3 4Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of the all that exists!} [7:54] This reminds Allah's Messenger Muhammad jg, that Allah li| At-Tabari 16:6.

149 Surah 12. Yusuf (19-20) (Part-12) has perfect knowledge in the persecution that his people committed against him and that He is able to stop them. However, He decided to give them respite, then

give Muhammad the victory and make him prevail over them, just as He gave Yusuf victory and made him prevail over his brothers. Allah said next, 4And they sold him for a Bakhs price, -for a few Dirhams} in reference to Yusuf's brothers selling him for a little price, according to Mujahid and 'Ikrimah. 'Bakhs' means decreased, just as Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah J Yj Llit ishalla have no fear, either of a Bakhs (a decrease in the reward of his good deeds) or a Rahaq (an increase in the punishment for his sins).} [72:13] meaning that Yusuf's brothers exchanged him for a miserably low price. Yet, he was so insignificant to them that had the caravan people wanted him for free, they would have given him for free to them! Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak said that, }And they sold him}, is in reference to Yusuf's brothers.*2 * They sold Yusuf for the lowest price, as indicated by Allah's statement next, ^jj} ifor a few Dirhams}, twenty Dirhams, according to 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud.*3 * Similar was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Nawf Al-BUcali, As- Suddi, Qatadah and 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, who added that they divided the Dirhams among themselves, each getting two Dirhams .' Ad-Dahhak commented on Allah's statement, m At-Jabari 16:12. * At-Jabari 16:14-17. At-Jabari 16:12. * At-Jabari 16:14.

152 Surah 12. Yusuf (21-22) (Part-12) He also ordered his wife to be kind to Yusuf and had good hopes for his future, because of his firm righteous behavior. He said to his wife, iMake his stay comfortable, maybe he will profit us or we shall adopt him as a son .} The man who bought Yusuf was the minister of Egypt at the time, and his title was 'Aziz'. Abu Ishaq narrated that Abu 'Ubaydah said that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "Three had the most insight: the 'Aziz of Egypt, who said to his wife, iMake his stay comfortable...}, the woman who said to her father, iO my father! Hire him...}, [28:26] and Abu Bakr As-Siddiq when he appointed 'Umar bin Al-Khattab to be the Khalifah after him, may Allah be pleased with them both." Allah said next that just as He saved Yusuf from his brothers, iTluts did I've establish Yusuf in the land}, in reference to Egypt, itlmt We might teach him the interpretation of events.} the interpretation of dreams, according to Mujahid and As- Suddi.12 ' Allah said next, iAtid Allah has full power and control over His affairs,} if He wills something, then there is no averting His decision, nor can it ever be stopped or contradicted. Rather, Allah has full power over everything and everyone else. Said bin Jubayr said while commenting on Allah's statement, 1,1 At-Tabari 16:19. At-Tabari 16:20.

4And Allah has full power and control over His affairs,} "He does what ever He wills." ' Allah said, ii& *JA^ 4but most of men know not.} meaning, have no knowledge of Allah's wisdom with regards to His creation, compassion and doing what He wills. Allah said next, 4And when he attained}, in reference to Prophet Yusuf, peace be upon him, ii®} ihis full manhood}, sound in mind and perfect in body, &C} 4We gave him wisdom and knowledge}, which is the prophethood that Allah sent him with for the people he lived among, 4thus We reward the doers of good.} because Yusuf used to do good in the obedience of Allah the Exalted. jCH JLS cji cJUj .4. .Vu-j ,aJ*i _j> fff&&& 4^5^ * fkfe A 423. And she, in whose house he was, sought to seduce him (to do an evil act), and she closed the doors and said: "Come on, O you." He said: "I seek refuge in Allah! Truly, he is my Rabb! He made my living in a great comfort! Verily, the wrongdoers will never be successful."} Wife of the 'Aziz loves Yusuf and plots against Him Allah states that the wife of the 'Aziz of Egypt, in whose house Yusuf resided and whose husband recommended that she takes care of him and be generous to him, tried to seduce Yusuf! She called him to do an evil act with her, because she loved him very much. Yusuf was very handsome, filled with m At-Tabari 16:21.

153 Sarah 12. Yusuf (24) (Part-12) manhood and beauty. She beautified herself for him, closed the doors and called him, iatid (she) said: "Come on, O you." } But he categorically refused her call, 4(>^ (if 4He said: "I seek refuge in Allah! Truly, he is my Rabb! He made my living in a great comfort!") as they used to call the chief and master a 'Rabb', Yusuf said to her, 'your husband is my master who provided me with comfortable living and was kind to me, so I will never betray him by committing immoral sins with his wife,' ^ V %} 4 Verily, the wrongdoers will never be successfid.} This was said by Mujahid, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Ishaq and severed others. The scholars differ in their recitation of, 4Hayta Laka}, whereby Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and several other scholars said that it means that she was calling him to herself.111 Al-Bukhari said; "Ikrimah said that, 4-zZ^ >11*^ 4Hayta Laka' } means, 'come on, O you', in the Aramaic language." Al-Bukhari collected this statement from 'Ikrimah without a chain of narration.121 Other scholars read it with the meaning, 'I am ready for you'. Ibn 'Abbas, Abu 'Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Abu Wa'il, 'Ikrimah and Qatadah were reported to have read this part of the Ayah this way and explained it in the manner we mentioned, as *1 am ready for you'. 'ifj S'*/. *1 o1 VP ll* 'Aij} 111 At-Tabari 16:27. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:214.

155 Surah 12. Yusuf (25-29) (Part-12) d^y>'k.~ TTA \ /- ^ x * - S' S' »S . s''' >-^3j ••*->] j_<n Jli— 1-11 Q.faxlUj j3j\$AA&' t /XjXj-b——= -fj^Cjtr.W JI LIX-Jj X £ b^Air?XllLtXahj Xgi iXtiXXO&Ao'-^xJXXjxiX 4>Uc3X':>Xo^H«A<A^X> ilr4 C-i li j^i>jx,xx»jxs >?,<.< » 'i > ^ . <- {^k~, J.Cip —3ij£}vXLjJJ (.gyifcL.<i'j IJCa i\$X>lAxtA'XAg_X'ijj_A-J ^^ means, 'Just as We showed him the evidence that turned him away from that sin, We save him from all types of evil and illegal sexual activity in all his affairs,' because, 4c\$-4Xj' l»iCj Cjtf'ff iSurely, he was one of Our Mukhlasin servants.} meaning, chosen, purified, designated, appointed and righte- ous. May Allah's peace and blessings be on him." > s < ' s' .s" V ^ util LiA'i)/ J liJu— Lilj> • 5- * 7" ' iaSJ>V cr* *!>? b cJfc % i oA J v! t£. /£ >> - /A * •- ** i<^ < /• c v ^ :/" / -A- * ,t IjM Ut -1* ,*<»;< <^>0 o\ J* -1-4—J Jpijj l£ li'If s''' •<- < »f / /• / •-'< 2"< » *i > > ^ ^ , j 1 -.*' / /> / *C 'ys<. U>u r rv ,«jrv5_A^ ' jj *1y\ -A* jo o!j 'X* (f- j'jA w pt* iX-T" Si Sf~=' Ji ,ij] JLi y-o Ui j* |«X-J bj 4™. OVi-blji.' C.V^ = lAjiJ tiytil—'ij 425. So f/iey raced to toif/i one another to the door, and she tore his shirt from the back. They both found her master (i.e. her husband) at the door. She said: "What is the recompense (punishment) for him who intended an evil design against your wife, except that he be put in prison or a painful torment?" } 111 At-Tabari 16:49.

4.26. He [Yiisuf] said: "It was she that sought to seduce me;" and a witness of her household bore witness (saying) : "If it be that his shirt is tomfrom the front, then her tale is true and he is a liar!" } 427. "But if it be that his shirt is tom from the back, then she has told a lie and he is speaking the truth!" } 428. So when he (her husband) saw his [Yusufs] shirt tom at the back, he Qier husband) said: "Surely, it is a plot of you women! Certainly mighty is your plot!" } 429. "O Yusuf ! Turn away from this! (O woman!) Ask forgivenessfor your sin, verily, you were of the sinful." } Allah says that Yusuf and the wife of the 'Aziz raced to the door, YUsuf running away from her and her running after him to bring him back to the room. She caught -up with him «^1 held on to his,shirt from the back, tearing it so tembt'ythat it fell off Yusufs back. Yusuf continued running from her, with her in pursuit. However, they found her master, her husband, at the front door. This is when she responded by deceit and evil plots, trying to exonerate herself and implicate him, saying, 4& ail %\ if C} 4What is the recompense (punishment)for him who intended an evil design against your wife. . . ?}, in reference to illegal sexual

intercourse, 4except that he be put in prison} 4*4% 4or a painful torment?} tormented severely with painful beating. Yusuf did not stand idle, but he declared the truth and exonerated himself from the betrayal she accused him of, 4ti> 4He [Yiisuf] said}, in truth and honesty,

257Surah 12. Yusuf(25-29) (Part-12 it was she that sought to seduce me}, and mentioned that she pursued him and pulled him towards her until she tore his shirt. dX 4 l+ul ji lt< l^Lj} 4And a witness of her household bore witness (saying): "If it be that his shirt is torn from the front...", not from the back, 4then her tale is true} that he tried to commit an illegal sexual act with her. Had he called her to have sex with him and she refused, she would have pushed him away from her and tore his shirt from the front, y^jSSb.'. i ' » •£ > > - t'V. cit j*j ot ob ol>y 4But if it be that his shirt is torn from the back, then she has told a lie and he is speaking the truth!} Had Yusuf run away from her, and this is what truly happened, and she set in his pursuit, she would have held to his shirt from the back to bring him back to her, thus tearing his shirt from the back. There is a difference of opinion over the age and gender of the witness mentioned here. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4 '-+1*1 o*Ui jL^•j} i and a witness of her household bore witness} "was a bearded man," meaning an adult male. Ath-Thawri reported that J&bir said that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He was from the king's entourage." Mujaljid, Tkrimah, Al-IJasari, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Isl>&q and others >also said that the witness was an adult male. Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4t+i*1 a*uS jLq~j} 4and a witness of her household bore witness}

758 Tafslr Ibn Katlur He was a babe in the cradle. Similar was reported from Abu Hurayrah, Hilal bin Yasaf, Al-Hasan, Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim, that the witness was a young boy who lived in the 'Aziz's house. 121 Ibn Jarir At-Tabari preferred this view. Allah's statement, iy, -V3 \$So when he saw his [Yusuf's] shirt torn at the back,} indicates that when her husband became certain that Yusuf was telling the truth and that his wife was lying when she heralded the accusation of betrayal at Yusuf, in ,*^1 ihe said: "Surely, it is a plot of you women!..."} He said, This false accusation and staining the young man's reputation is but a plot of many that you, women, have,' ^Certainly mighty is your plot!} The Aziz ordered Yusuf, peace be upon him, to be discrete about what happened, if jff\ 40 Yusuf ! Turn away from this!}, do not mention to anyone what has happened, 4And ask forgiveness for your sin,} addressing his wife. The 'Aziz was an easy man, or gave excuse to his wife because she saw in Yusuf an appeal she could not resist. He said to her, 'Ask forgiveness for your sin, the evil desire that you wanted to satisfy with this young man,' and then inventing false accusations about him,' At-Tabari 16:56 12] Af-Tabari 16:54-55.

Jr tr* .jzc&vix iverily, you were of the :,r< ^ *• s''\ ' %' - < <jJU^jH-Ca u aji <LtttA iiJtjjs6p > >?.o '+f'»s < >t' ' \"i-p'rtj^ \j-2> f4j l lo-Cx.sj>j*e± *<*jj*a)u-j tei^» i4s4jUo£^<S44'*^^b>^ 9^*^“ P.^vr.-u\E^j\sCiu by-^b cJib(jltjj^dc-lljlliO'jLSbobo^0CL^Lbj *jL-JJzjJ r*-* j° '.U^r4 <&. Id ±x?b Sp>l ^-4>? 3r-i j-^l> 'S ^ ££t ,££ C2 Sp£ c^', 'I*" "li" £>* .; t* *J» ^V—> L^J-* *>^0 ^1 Gi 5j £S u£ 4? &> 436 :§*A •A~^ c* /*JX> «*23j 4-i ^'-ZJ ,v'< S £ij ^ p^j r%o^a-X^ b_5vbj — it di& yj jf ./ • *<• * , ** ' * } ms sjp 0/4 A^! * & U\ f3, ixp i Vi jLQi yh\ > %1 Ifijg& Jpd% Jj vl^g #0)Vfi' 430. A»rf women in the city said: "The wife of the 'Aziz is seeking to seduce iter (stave) young num, indeed she loves him violently; verily, we see her in plain error."} 432 . So when she heard of their accusation, she sent for them and prepared a banquet for them; she gave each one of them a knife, and she said [to Yusuf]:

"Come out before them." Then, when they saw him, they exalted him (at his beauty) and (in their astonishment) cut their hands. They said: "How perfect is Allah! No man is this! This is none other than a noble angel!"; 432. She said: "This is he (the young man) about whom you did blame me, and I did seek to seduce him, but he refused. And now if he refuses to obey my order, he shall certainly be sinful." -yJ 1 J» O6- 4^ >Sj -#*" JJLrf ^ Sji 11^ C>- LjA« ^ . '1 . . i I Os .TvYn

cast into prison, and will be one of those who are disgraced."} ^33. He said: "O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one of the ignorant."} 434. So his Lord answered his invocation and turned away from him their plot. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} The News reaches Women in the City, Who also plot against Yusuf Allah states that the news of what happened between the wife of the 'Aziz and Yusuf spread in the city, that is, Egypt, and people talked about it, 4And women in the city said...}, such as women of chiefs and princes said, while admonishing and criticizing the wife of the 'Aziz, o6 tils} 4The wife of the 'Aziz is seeking to seduce her (slave) young man,}, she is luring her servant to have sex with her, it 1} {indeed she loves him violently;}, her love for him filled her heart and engulfed it, 4verily, we see her in plain error.}, by loving him and trying to seduce him. 4So when she heard of their accusation,} especially their statement, "indeed she loves him violently." Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, "They heard of Yusuf's beauty and wanted to see him, so they said these words in order to get a look at him." This is when,

cy.\$} she sent for them}, invited them to her house, ji OXcl)} and prepared a banquet for them.} Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and several others commented that she prepared a sitting room which had couches, pillows [to recline on] and food that requires knives to cut, such as citron. 1 11 This is why Allah said next, Irr-t y and she gave each one of them a knife}, as a part of her plan of revenge for their plot to see Yusuf, and she said [to Yusuf]: "Come out before them."}, for she had asked him to stay somewhere else in the house, i\ S} iThen, when} he went out and, & &f} they saw him, they exalted him} they thought highly of him and were astonished at what they saw. They started cutting their hands in amazement at his beauty, while thinking that they were cutting the citron with their knives. Therefore, they injured their hands with the knives they were holding, according to several reports of TafsirP Others said that after they ate and felt comfortable, and after having placed citron in front of them, giving each one of them a knife, the wife of the 'Aziz asked them, "Would you like to see Yusuf?" They said, "Yes." So she sent for him to come in front of them and when they saw him, they started cutting At-Tabari 16:71-72. At-Tabari 16:76-78.

to obey me. Some scholars said that when the women saw Yusuf's beauty, she told them about his inner beauty that they did not know of, being chaste and beautiful from the inside and outside. She then threatened him, iAnd now if he refuses to obey my order, he shall certainly be cast into prison, and will be one of those who are disgraced.} This is when Prophet Yusuf sought refuge with Allah from their evil and wicked plots, iHe said: "O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me..."} illegal sexual acts, unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them} Yusuf invoked Allah: If You abandon me and I am reliant on myself, then I have no power over myself, nor can I bring harm or benefit to myself, except with Your power and will. Verily, You are sought for each and everything, and our total reliance is on You Alone for each and everything. Please, do not

abandon me and leave me to rely on myself, for then, "I will feel inclined towards them and be one of the ignorant." So his Lord answered his invocation} YQsuf, peace be upon him, was immune from error by Allah's will, and He saved him from accepting the advances of the wife of the 'Aziz'. He preferred prison, rather than accept her illicit call. This indicates the best and most perfect grade in this case, for Yusuf was youthful, beautiful and full of manhood. His master's wife was calling him to herself, and she was the wife of the 'Aziz of Egypt. She was also very beautiful and wealthy, as well as having a great social rank. He refused all this and preferred prison, for he feared Allah and hoped to earn His reward. It is recorded in the Two Sahuhs that the Messenger of Allah

said, ;iUp li; Olij fi*! ;dj» YJ ^1» Y dk ^ <5>l p4^*i 4*—" 1 liUj tj«Jj o Cy 9" li! y-T*****-^ jji** ijtol jJLo Y ii.i.A t J \,rt7 jj t*-ip tiill olit ^J :JUi JUj>-_j ' _-,<a'-4 oli oi^I i*~«j cJteit t< «»lile- c i>Ui Qli il jSi jj «Allah will give shade to seven, on the Day when there will be no shade but His : A just ruler, a youth who Iws been brought up in the worship of Allah, a man whose heart is attached to the Masjid, from the time he goes out of the Masjid until he gets back to it, two persons who love each other only for Allah's sake and they meet and part in Allah's cause only, a man who gives charitable gifts so secretly that his left hand does not know what his right hand has given, a man who refuses the call of a charming woman of noble birth for illicit intercourse with her and says: "I am afraid of Allah, and a person who remembers Allah in seclusion and his eyes are then flooded with tears oij/t i£ 435. Then it occurred to them, after they had seen the proofs (of his innocence), to imprison him for a time> Yusuf is imprisoned without Justification Allah says, "Then it occurred to them that it would be in their interest to imprison Yusuf for a time, even after they were convinced of his innocence and saw the proofs of his truth, honesty and chastity.' It appears, and Allah knows best, that they imprisoned him after the news of what happened spread. They wanted to pretend that Yusuf was the one who tried to seduce the 'Aziz's wife and that they punished him with imprisonment. This is why when the Pharaoh asked YUusuf to leave jail a long time afterwards, he refused to leave until his innocence was ascertained and the allegation of his betrayal was refuted. When this was successfully achieved, 111 Fath Al-Bari 2 : 168, Muslim 2 :715.

YQsuf left the prison with his honor intact, peace be upon him. Zsr\$ Jlij ti[tlijJ J15 jCli U&Z%4A #t & j-J-1 And there entered with him two young men in the prison. One of them said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) pressing wine." The other said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) carrying bread on my head and birds were eating thereof." (They said): "Inform us of the interpretation of this. Verily, we think you are one of the doers of good."} Two Jail Mates ask Yusuf to interpret their Dreams Qatadah said, "One of them was the king's distiller and the other was his baker. "I 11 Each of these two men had a dream and asked Yusuf to interpret it for them. vfj IL J jj .4^1-f* — —> — err z*}»jy i wv IL» c_v'j (**> oj-tfi 'i fy %A oiy (Lie *i> ,jj —iJJ'j ,j< 4l> J U U JiiyUuj r*. y ,j;0' _/^=1 (j;Ol Jcj 437. He said: "No food will come to you as your provision, but I will inform its interpretation before it comes. This is of that which my Lord has taught me. Verily, I have abandoned the religion of a people that believe not in Allah and are disbelievers in the Hereafter."} 438. "And I have followed the religion of my fathers, - Ibrahim, Ishaq and Ya'qub and never could we attribute any partners whatsoever to Allah. This is from the grace of Allah to us and to mankind, but most men thank not.} Yusuf calls His Jail Mates to Tawhid even before He interprets Their Dreams YQsuf, peace be upon him, told the two men that he has knowledge in the interpretation of whatever they saw in their m At-fabari 16:95.

< s worthy of worship except Allah alone without partners, 4^4 iis from the grace of Allah to us\$, He has' revealed it to us andj ordained it on us, 4and to mankind,^, to whom He has sent us as callers to Tawhid, ibut most men thank not.\$ they do not admit Allah's favor and blessing of send- ing the Messengers to them, but rather, \M iHave changed the blessings ofAllah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house ofdestructionf (14:28] as r i* mgm >. < Iff s't-i'ivs.'i' - .ujt »4ii*j * _jy>- a i C,XLzffiv 1\$) r-f .. ^c _ - .Jlij.»»l J) ***" J t—3L>vCf W* 0, 432 c a J 5- 4.0: o^ii vl^ vj o] ^Lii oj^&\$ £ pfe&'y^ itLil vi ^ V c>;UJl (*4^' *i?:i »Ij^ V(ljj_i 439. "O too companions of the prison! Are many different lords (gods) better or Allah, the One, the Irresistible?"} 440. "You do not worship besides Him but only names which you have named (forged) - you and your fathers - for which Allah has sent down no authority. The command is for none but Allah . He has commanded that you worship none but Him

168 Tafsxr Ibn Kathir that is the straight religion, but most men know not."} Prophet Yusuf went on calling his two prison companions to worship Allah alone, without partners, and to reject whatever is being worshipped instead of Him like the idols, which were worshipped by the people of the two men, Yusuf said, i'j&R j*9'ia 4*3 iAre many different lords (gods) better or Allah, the One, the Irresistible?} to Whose grace and infinite kingdom everything and everyone has submitted in humiliation. Prophet Yusuf explained to them next that it is because of their ignorance that they worship false deities and give them names, for these names were forged and are being transferred from one generation to the next generation. They have no proof or authority that supports this practice, hence his statement to them, ot Ki •“*’ 4/^ ifor ivhich Allah has sent down no authority or proof and evidence. He then affirmed that the judgement, decision, will and kingdom are all for Allah alone, and He has commanded all of His servants to worship none but Him. He said, ithat is the straight religion, This, Tawhld of Allah and directing all acts of worship at Him alone in sincerity, that I am calling you to is the right, straight religion that Allah has ordained and for which He has revealed what He wills of proofs and evidences,’ ibut most men know not.}, and this is why most of them are idolators, vZi&JSj j5j fcj} iAnd most of mankind will not believe even if you eagerly desire it.} [12:103) When Yusuf finished calling them, he started interpreting their

dreams for them, os £Di SkJ3 41^^ Jg & 4 ll'J<jCwL‘-lj A-i tS *4rA> 441 . "O two companions of the prison! As for one of you, he will pour out winefar his master to drink; and as for the other, he will be crucified and birds will eatfrom his head. Thus is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire."} The Interpretation ofthe Dreams Yusuf said, 4£-»- ,*jj a Ul ^y^j} 40 two companions of the prison! As far one of you, he will pour out winefor his master to drink;} to the man who saw in a dream that he was pressing wine. He did not direct this speech at him, however, so that to lessen the grief of the other person. This is why he made his statement indirect, 4*Uj ^ iand as far the other, he will be crucified and birds will eat from his head.} which is the interpretation of the other man's dream in which he saw himself carrying bread above his head. Yusuf told them that the decision about their matter has already been taken and it shall come to pass. This is because the dream! is tied to a bird's leg, as long as it is not truthfully interpreted. If it is interpreted, then it becomes a reality. Ath-Thawri said that ‘Imarah bin Al-Qa‘qa‘ narrated that Ibrahim said that ‘Abdullah bin MasTkd said, “When they said what they said to him, and he explained their dreams to them, they replied, *We did not see anything at all.’ This is when he said, 4<jC:ifrj 4j [&>} 477ius is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire.y* 1 At-Tabari 16 : 108

The understanding in this is that he who claims that he saw a dream and was given its interpretation, then he will be tied to its interpretation, and Allah has the best knowledge. There is an honorable Hadith that Imam Ahmad collected from Mu'awiyah bin Haydah that the Prophet ﷺ said. $\text{U jS\}t \text{JjLj}$ "The dream is tied to a bird's leg, as long as it is not interpreted. If it is interpreted, it becomes a reality.[^] (1) *— H414 gG /jl ifi iEj)J E*} ^ vLi 442. And he said to the one whom he knew to be saved: "Mention me to your king." But Shaytan made him forget to mention it to his master. So [Yiisuf] stayed in prison a few (more) years.} Yusuf asks the King's Distiller to mention Him to the King YQsuf knew that the distiller would be saved. So discretely, so that the other man's suspicion that he would be crucified would not intensify, he said, 4-&fj y.^k=^>\} iMention me to your King.} asking him to mention his story to the king. That man forgot YusuFs request and did not mention his story to the king, a plot from the devil, so that Allah's Prophet would not leave the prison. This is the correct meaning of, cfc; 'I ' 4But Shaytan made him forget to mention it to his master.} that it refers to the man who was saved. As was said by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others.¹² ' As for, 'a few years', or, Bida' in Arabic, it means between three and nine, Ahmad 4:10. At-Tabari 16:113.

u\ tmm •> -->f > my s ».s \$.s <,>.* \ ' . ' iuJUj VM .>f> >>«.i -" <'J"J J 4JL-J ja))JkijTJL*o>*l7bO(jCr;;i^jiO)fr;Jr' ,_*£> \j liU'J Or- ut*£^Lb ' < s c '? ' <> *i '? 1\&\< i" according to Muj&hid and Qatadah.[^] * Wahb bin Munabbih saitjl, "AyyOb suffered froijn the illness for seven years, YQsuf remained in prison for seven years and Bukhtanassar (Nebuchadnezzar - Chaldean king of Babylon) was tormented for seven years. "21 p is} Xi\ ip' £— Sil£=»t i}^f >6" r-e - * ^ y>A>- £—J uJU%fr 4# fcw C54 jji; Ci^U 'f~£ o) 'J>lj 4 5^^ r> &Jk& '?-> mM c& £ 4' \$j o£—; yjj-i; grJ- j U-il <ju^j(Q;1 ^ Jfi J#J o-at Ji^\$ *££ I^j^ ip* £. (Jll'i Ju; ^ ^ £\$;SjK1j CU XU V) z4pJS 4 »jL>ii fJwai- G Gj Sc—. 0jP[> i£ ii£ i£* Ss£ f SSA4 «4 *i ^1 s* £2 cS& 3*p > - . - Xv^^Wi iA» 443. And the king (ofEgypt) said: "Verily, I saw (in a dream) seven fat cows, whom seven lean ones were devouring, and seven green ears of com, and (seven) others dry. O notables! Al-Tabari 16:115. Al-Tabari 16:114.

Explain to me my dream, if it be that you can interpret dreams." 444. They said: "Mixed up false dreams and we are not skilled in the interpretation ofdreams.'> 445. Then the man who was released, now at length remembered and said: "I will tell you its interpretation, so send me forth."} 446. (He said): "O Yusuf, the man of truth! Explain to us seven fat cows whom seven lean ones were devouring, and seven green ears of com, and (seven) others dry, that I may return to the people, and that they may know."} 447. [Yusuf] said: "For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual and that which you reap you shall leave it in the ears, (all) except a little of it which you may eat."} 448. "Then will come after that, seven hard (years), which will devour ivhat you have laid by in advancefor than, (all) except a little of that which you have guarded (stored)." 449. "Then thereafter will come a year in which people will have abundant rain and in which they will press (ivine and oil)" } The Dream ofthe King ofEgypt The King of Egypt had a dream that Allah the Exalted made a reason for YusuFs release from prison, with his honor and reputation preserved. When the king had this dream, he was astonished and fearful and sought its interpretation. He gathered the priests, the chiefs of his state and the princes and told them what he had seen in a dream, asking them to interpret it for him. They did not know its interpretation and as an excuse, they said, 4"jJ 1^J\} 4Mixed up false dreams}, which you saw, iUth

(iVr jyii£ Cj} 4and we are not skilled in the interpretation of dreams.) They said, had your dream been a vision rather than a mixed up false dream, we would not have known its

interpretation. The man who was saved from the two, who were Yusuf's companions in prison, remembered. Shaytan plotted to make him forget the request of Yusuf, to mention his story to the king. Now, years later, he remembered after forgetfulness and said to the king and his entourage, 41 will tell you its interpretation, he interpretation of this dream, 4s0 send me forth. to the prison, to Yusuf, the man of truth. |So they sent him, and he said to Yusuf, 40 Yusuf, the man of truth! Explain to us..} and mentioned the king's dream to him. Yusuf's Interpretation of the King's Dream This is when Yusuf, peace be upon him, told the interpretation of the dream, without criticizing the man for forgetting his request that he had made to him. Neither did he make a precondition that he be released before explaining the meaning. Rather, he said, 4Q> Jyt&} 4For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual} you will receive the usual amount of rain and fertility for seven consecutive years.' He interpreted the cows to be years, es, ext because cows till the land that produce fruits and vegetables; which represent the green ears of corn in the dream. He n recommended what they should do during these fertile years, 4and that (the harvest) which you reap you shall leave it in the ears, (all) except a little of it which you may eat.} He said, 'Whatever you harvest during those seven fertile years, leave it in the ears so as to preserve it better. This help the harvest stay healthy longer, except the amount you need to eat, which should not be substantial. Stay away from extravagance, so that you use what remains of {the will that .way the

harvest during the seven years of drought that will follow the seven fertile years.' This was represented by the seven lean cows that eat the seven fat cows. During the seven years of drought, they will eat from the harvest they collected during the seven fertile years, as represented by the dry ears of corn in the dream. Yusuf told them that during these years, the remaining ears will not produce anything and whatever they try to plant, will not produce any harvest, so he said, xb j -4 c\$} iwhich will devour what you have laid by in advance far them, (all) except a little of that which you have guarded (stored). He delivered the good news to them that after the consecutive years of drought, there will come a fertile year, during which people will receive rain and the land will produce in abundance. The people will then press wine and oil as usual. JL> L d&j Jli jl}j} ij ifQi. c Jli Jj Ctr-l) 'J& 0* £»Sj 13 jpJl j3l Y 2i' £)t) ^ y /jJj .aJu 4> AJfJ ^ Yj, ybV J-£)l 6^ Xt 450. And the king said: "Bring him to me." But when the messenger came to him, [Yusuf] said: "Return to your king and ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, my Lord (Allah) is Well-Aware of their plot.'" } 451. (The king) said (to the women): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yusuf?" The women said: "Allah forbid! No evil know we against him!" The wife of the 'Aziz said: Now the truth is manifest (to all)', it was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful." } 452. [Then Yusuf said: "I asked for this inquiry] in order that he may know that I betrayed him not in (his) absence." And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers.} 453. "And I free not myself (from the blame). Verily, the self is

inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His mercy (upon whom He wills). Verily, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful." } The King investigates what happened between the Wife of the 'Aziz, the Women in the City, and Yusuf Allah narrates to us that when the king was conveyed the interpretation of his dream, he liked Yusuf's interpretation and felt sure that it was true. He realized the

virtue of Prophet Yusuf, recognized his knowledge in the interpretation of dreams and valued his good conduct with his subjects in his country. The king said, 'Bring him to me.' 'Release him from prison and bring him to me.' When the king's emissary came to Yusuf and conveyed the news of his imminent release, Yusuf refused to leave the prison until the king and his subjects declare his innocence and the integrity of his honor, denouncing the false accusation that the wife of the 'Aziz made against him. He wanted them to know that sending him to prison was an act of injustice and aggression, not that he committed an offense that warranted it. He said, 'Return to your lord (i.e. king...)' The Sunnah of our Prophet ﷺ praised Prophet Yusuf asserted his virtues, honor, elevated rank and patience, Allah's peace and blessings be on him. The Musnad and Two Sahihis recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "I am more liable to be in doubt than Ibrahim when he said 'U and pay the the \$My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead...'"} ii-J l yyU\ j /jSj jJl -Ul 11

VjeijJi cirV may send His meraj on Lilt! He wished to have powerful support! If I were to stay in prison for such a long time as Yusuf did, I would have accepted the offer. n In another narration collected by Ahmad from Abu Hurayrah,

the Prophet ﷺ said about Yusuf's statement, " ...and ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, my Lord (Allah) is Well-Aware of their plot.'" } "// it was me, I would have accepted the offer rather than await my exoneration first. Allah said (that the king asked), 4He said, "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yusuf?" } The king gathered those women who cut their hands, while being hosted at the house of the wife of the 'Aziz. He asked them all, even though he was directing his speech at the wife of his minister, the 'Aziz in particular. He asked the women who cut their hands, £} iWhat was your affair. what was your story with regards to, J. c *.? *" <> > " f, Y Cf*Jj *1? iwhen you did seek to seduce Yusuf? } on the day of the banquet? & Of £k 3^- £\$ } 4The women said: "Allah forbid! No evil know we against him!" } The women answered the king, 'Allah forbid that Yusuf be Ahmad 2 :326, Fath Al-Bari 8 :216 Muslim 1 :133. 121 Ahmad 2:346.

guilty of this, for by Allah, we never knew him to do evil.' This; is when, 4The wife of the 'Aziz said: "Now the truth has Hashasa . . ." } or the truth is manifest to all, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others. ' Hashasa also means, 'became clear and plain', iit was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful.] when he said, was she that sought to seduce me.} \ >\$ } 4in order that he may know that I betrayed him not in (Id's) absence. She said, 'I admit this against myself so that my husband knows that I did not betray him in his absence and that adultery did not occur. I tried to seduce this young man and he refused, and I am admitting this so that he knows I am innocent,' Cj aZ •\$ £1% } 4And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers. And I free not myself (from the blame). } She said, "I do not exonerate myself from blame, because the soul wishes and lusts, and this is what made me seduce him," for, 4Verily, the (human) self is inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His mercy (upon whom He wills). } whom Allah the Exalted wills to grant them immunity, fj i>i^ At-Tabari 16:138.

4Verily, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. } This is the most viable and suitable understanding for the continuity of the story and the meanings of Arabic speech. Al- Mawardi mentioned this in his Tafsir, in support of it, it was also preferred by Imam Abu Al-'Abbas Ibn Taymiyyah who wrote about it in detail in a separate work. It was said Yusuf's peace be upon him is the one who said, in order that he

(the 'Aziz) may know that I betrayed him not with his wife, \$in (his) absence).} until the end of Ayah (53) He said, *1 sent back the emissary, so that the king would investigate my innocence and the 'Aziz be certain that, <35 jii# 41 betrayed him not}, with his wife, 4o\$ffi Y ill iin (his) absence. And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers.}' This is the only explanation presented by Ibn Jarir At-Tabari and Ibn Abi Hatim, but the first view is stronger and more obvious because it is a continuation of what the wife of the 'Aziz said in the presence of the king. Yusuf was not present at all during this time, for he was released later on and brought to the king by his order. # :f -J S3 4 454. And the king said : "Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person." Then, when he spoke to him, he said: "Verily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted."} 455. [Yiisuf] said: "Set me over the storehouses of the land; I will indeed guard them with full knowledge."}

YusufsRankwith the King ofEgypt Allah states that when he became aware of YUusufs innocence and his innocense of what he was accused of, the king said, jfo} 4Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person.}, That I may make him among my close aids and associates,' iThen, when he spoke to him}, when the king spoke to YUusufand further recognized his virtues, great ability, brilliance, good conduct and perfect mannerism, he said to him, iVerily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted.} The king said to Yusuf, "You have assumed an exalted status with us and are indeed fully trusted.' Yusuf, peace be upon him said, iSet me over the storehouses of the land; 1 will indeed guard them with full knowledge.} YUusuf praised himself, for this is allowed when one's abilities are unknown and there is a need to do so. He said that he is, iHafiz}, an honest guard, 4p£} 4'Alim}, having knowledge and wisdom about the job he is to be entrusted with. Prophet Yusufasked the king to appoint him as minister of finance for the land, responsible for the harvest storehouses, in which they would collect produce for the years of drought which he told them will come. He wanted to be th!e guard, so that he could dispense the harvest in the wisest, best and most beneficial way. The king accepted YUusufs offer, for lie was eager to draw YUusuf close to him and to honor him. So

emm &\$y tjiyJsj J4 ^fdjt^cryy>fdi^j>^ ftlJa^j*Vs^y oyC^j&j\y~a\yS)) oj^Gi,\$^bj l^® --**<-j*->jj jjo^ ijJl/S-d) alii4^£.:>Xa-J oyjJeYljs^f-3s\$ sjUiujs 2ii^>ii' ijfc \$ ^ o>iiA>J .1)UjJj^=uIjli-I lilllJ-->jii 4A«d We make not to be lost the reward of the good doers. And verily, the reward of the Here- after is better for those who believed and had Taqwa .} Allah states that what He has prepared for His Prophet Yusuf, peace be upon him, in the Hereafter is much greater, subs- tantial and honored than the authority He gave him in this life. Allah said about His Prophet Sulaymdn (Solomon), peace jDe upon him, _jji> liljJ jS Cjlliic ljci^> ti& kxt "f ol> 4 V- cA*J i" "This is Our gift, so spend or withhold, no account will be asked ofyou." And verily, for him is a near access to Us, and a good (final) rehim (Paradise).} [38:39-40] Yusuf, peace be upon him, was appointed minister of finance by Ar-Rayyan bin Al-Walld, king of Egypt at the time, instead of the 'Aziz who bought him and the husband of she who tried to seduce him. The king of Egypt embraced Islam at the hands of Yusuf, peace be upon him, according to Mujahid. * .'m. >"* I -I' . • S' V* > " 'tf i'T, r>«vV (*®>+*- *-b A (*A> Mir >—«—_>> •m-jTi, .j; - m^A 1 li[Vjtr*i '\$~4 si rr^i 'jtIJ

458. And YUusufs brethren came and they entered unto him, and he recognized them, but they recognized him not.} 459. And when he furnished them with their provisions, he said: "Bring me a brother of yours from your father. See you not that I give full measure, and that I am the best of the

hosts?"} 460. "But if you bring him not to me, there shall be no measure (of com) for you with me, nor shall you come near me."} 461. They said: "We shall try to get permission (for him) from his father, and verily, we shall do it."} 462. And [Yusuf] told his servants to put their money into their bags, so that they might know it when they go back to their people; in order that they might come again.} Yusuf's Brothers travel to Egypt As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Isjiq and several others said that

the reason why Yusuf's brothers went to Egypt, is that after

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2722–2763]

Yusuf became minister of Egypt and the seven years of abundance passed, then came the seven years of drought that struck all areas of Egypt. The drought also reached the area of Kana'an (Canaan), where Prophet Ya'qub, peace be upon him, and his children resided. Prophet Yusuf efficiently guarded the people's harvest and collected it, and what he collected became a great fortune for the people. This also permitted Yusuf to give gifts to the people who sought his aid from various areas who came to buy food and provisions for their families. Yusuf would not give a family man more than whatever a camel could carry, as annual provisions for them. Yusuf himself did not fill his stomach from this food, nor did the king and his aids eat except one meal a day. By doing so, the people could sustain themselves with what they had for the remainder of the seven years. Indeed, Yusuf was a mercy from Allah sent to the people of Egypt. Yusuf's brothers were among those who came to Egypt to buy food supplies, by the order of their father: They knew that the 'Aziz of Egypt was selling food to people who need it for a low price, so they took some merchandise from their land with them to exchange it for food. They were ten, because Ya'qub

peace be upon him kept his son and Yusuf's brother Binyamin with him. Binyamin was the dearest of his sons to him after Yusuf. When Prophet Yusuf's brothers entered on him in his court and the center of his authority, he knew them the minute he saw them. However, they did not recognize him because they got rid of him when he was still young, and sold him to a caravan of travelers while unaware of their destination. They could not have imagined that Yusuf would end up being a minister, and this is why they did not recognize him, while he did recognize them. As-Suddi said that Yusuf started talking to his brothers and asked them, "What brought you to my land?" They said, "O, 'Aziz, we came to buy provisions." He asked them, "You might be spies." They said, "Allah forbids." He asked them, "Where are you from?" They said, "From the area of Kana'an, and our father is Allah's Prophet Ya'qub." He asked them, "Does he have other children besides you?" They said, "Yes, we were twelve brothers. Our youngest died in the desert, and he used to be the dearest to his father. His full brother is alive and his father kept him, so that his closeness compensates him for losing our youngest brother (who died)." Yusuf ordered that his brothers be honored and allowed to remain, and when he furnished them with their provisions, according to their needs and gave them what they wanted to buy, he said to them, "Bring me your brother from your father's side whom you mentioned, so that I know that you have told me the truth." He continued, "See you not that I give full measure, and that I am the best of the hosts?" encouraging them to return to him. He then threatened them, "But if you bring him not to me, there shall be no measure (of com) for you with me."

He threatened them that if the next time they come without Binyamin with them, they will not be allowed to buy the food that they need, Is v 'oy V> 4" ...tior shall you come near me." They said: "We shall try to get permission (for him)from his father, and verily, we shall do it."} They said, "We will try our best to bring him with us, so that we spare no effort to prove to you that we are truthful in what we told you about ourselves.' Allah said, 4And [Yiisuf] told his servants}, or his slaves, 4to put their money}, or the merchandise they brought with them to exchange for food, iinto their bags,}, while they were unaware, 4^L>P*fj_ 'J&} iin order that they might come again.} It was said that Yusuf did this because he feared that his brothers might not have any more merchandise they could bring with them to exchange for food. Ji tss jjK %£ C\k (j£ dl££ ji- ijtii Jj *—j""& iff. ji JS 463. So, when they returned to theirfather, they said: "O our father! No more measure ofgrain shall we get (unless we take our brother). So send our brother with us, and ive shall get our measure and tndy, we will guard him."} 464. He said: "Can I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yusuf] to you aforetime? But Allah is the Best to guard, andHe is the Most Merciful oftfwsewhoshow mercy."}

Yusufs Brothers ask Ya'qub's Permission to send Their Brother Binyamin withThem to Egypt Allah says that when they went back to their father, tt£ litii >>> ithcy said: "O our father! No more measure of grain shall we get..."} 'after this time, unless you send our brother Binyamin with us. So send him with us, and we shall get our measure and we shall certainly guard him.' Some scholars read this Ayah in a way that means, 'and he shall get his ration.' They said, iand truly, we will guard him.}, 'do not fear for his safety, for he will be returned back to you.' This is what they said to Ya'qOb about their brother Yusuf, T A La i"Send him with us tomorrmo to enjoy himself and play, and verily, we will take care ofhim."} [12:12] This is why Prophet Ya'qub said to them, iCan I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yusuf] to you aforetime?} He asked them, "Will you do to him except what you did to his brother Yusuf before, when you took him away from me and separated me from him?" (Uyl yu Oiii- iBut Allah is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful of those who shoiv mercy.} Ya'qub said, 'Allah has the most mercy with me among all those who show mercy, He is compassionate with me for my old age, feebleness and eagerness for my son. I invoke Allan to return him to me, and to allow him and I to be together;! for surely, He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy.'

as&m nr mm V, Os Iddiftji\$3u I *jjli iyOiUJj^cru^i'jv^jiy>_jUail>-_^rtilijj Kil't-tiI* ,1| ' -> ,-' f > - - , > i^jfe=as^r^jki <—'j'Jdrjy*- £j~*Jls_j ^ -ftvt L)j>> >.<« :« i^ci l2j^ i^VJ j^j, olj .U . .rt> -°A1a cAT l OH foj. olj <%* -Aa? J^" a'ajjj C0 feJ ^ 3ii j^, ^-- ri.- . >.;; <- •>, ~o/J ^o* 9» Cs*- r=*~-%. it? o' ^ J&j if f* d6 iif Jli ^+2j>* »jif» lili 465. And when they opened their bags, they found their money had been returned to them. They said: "O our father! What (more) can we desire? This, our money has been returned to us; so we shall get (more) food for our fa- mily, and we shall guard our brother and add one more measure ofa camel's load. This quantity is easy (for the king to give)." } 466. He [Ya'qub] said: "I will not send him with you until you swear a solemn oath to me in Allah's Name, that you will bring him back to me unless you are yourselves surrounded (by enemies)," And when they had sworn their solemn oath, he said: "Allah is the Witness to what we lutve said."} They find TheirMoney returned to Their Bags Allah says, when Yusuf's brothers opened their bags, they found their merchandise inside them, for Yusuf had ordered his servants to return it to their bags. When they found then- merchandise in their bags, 4j£ £ 6£ts \$6}

187 Surah 12. Yusuf (65-66) (Part-13) } They said: "O our father! What (more) can we desire?..."}, what more can we ask for, 4 This, our money has been returned to us; } Qatadah commented (that they said), "What more can we ask for, our merchandise was returned to us and the 'Aziz Jias given us the sufficient load we wanted?" ' They said next, <03 I 4 so we shall get (more) food for our family, }, 'if you send our brother with us the next time we go to buy food for our family,' ? 3\$ gfl iiij} i and we shall guard our brother and add one more measure of a camel's load. } since YQsuf, peace be upon him, gave each man a camel's load of com. 4^ &£=. &>} i This quantity is easy (for the king to give). } They said these words to make their case more appealing, saying that taking their brother with them is worth this gain; 4ji* •dSi yje o' 4He [Ya'qub (Jacob)] said: "I will not send him with you until\ you swear a solemn oath to me in Allah's Name..."}, until you swear by Allah with the strongest oath, iu J "ji JftZ} i that you will bring him back to me unless you are yourselves surrounded (by enemies)}, unless you were all overwhelmed and were unable to rescue him, 4-H-fLV *>'» tji} i Atid when they had sworn their solemn oath}, he affirmed it further, saying, 111 At-Tabari 16:162.

& b& 4 Allah is the Witness to what we have said. } Ibn Ishaq commented, "Ya'qub did that because he had no choice but to send them to bring necessary food supplies for their survival. So he sent Binyamin with them." 467. And he said: "O my sons! Do not enter by one gate, but enter by different gates, and I cannot avail you against Allah at all. Verily, the decision rests only with Allah. In Him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him." } 468. And when they entered according to their father's advice, it did not avail them in the least against (the will of) Allah; it was but a need of Ya'qub's inner self which he discharged. And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him, but most men know not. } Ya'qub orders His Children to enter Egypt from Different Gates Allah says that Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ordered his children, when he sent Binyamin with them to Egypt, to enter from different gates rather than all of them entering from one gate. Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka*b, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak Qatadah, As-Suddi and several others said that he feared the evil eye for them, because they were handsome and looked beautiful and graceful. He feared that people might direct the evil eye at them, because the evil eye truly harms, by Allah's decree, and brings down the mighty warrior-rider from his horse. He next said, ot\$ viSi (1 i and I cannot avail you against Allah at all.) m At-Jabari 16:164.

this precaution will not resist Allah's decision and appointed decree. Verily, whatever Allah wills, cannot be resisted or stopped, ili j* 'ju4 ill* f'ojjpfjii jyLii a&j cJ&y ik ^ f ^ J* ^ # " •> -M 4 "Verily, the decision rests only with Allah. In Him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him." And when they entered according to their father's advice, it did not avail them in the least against (the will of) Allah ; it was but a need of Ya'qub's inner self which he discharged. }, as a precaution against the evil eye, Cl .j* jJ 4 And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him, } he had knowledge that he implemented, according to Qatadah and Ath-Thawri. 111 Ibn Jarir said that this part of the Ayah means, he has knowledge that We taught him, 4&C Y '&} i but most men know not. ^ , 2) \y<k= KL> J.6Z-, yj AJJ ul ii\ ju cufC jc IJZ» Cjj} 469. And when they went in before Yusuf, he took his brother (Binyamin) to himself and said: "Verily, I am your brother, so grieve not for what they used to do." } Yusuf comforts Binyamin Allah states that when Yusuf's brothers went in before him along with his full brother Binyamin, he invited them to a place of honor as privileged guests. He granted them

gifts and generous hospitality and kindness. He met his brother in confidence and told him the story of what happened to him and that he was in fact his brother. He said to him, At-Tabari 16:168. 121 Ibid.

'J) 'igrieve not) nor feel sad for what they did to me.' He ordered Binyamin to hide the news from them and to refrain from telling them that the 'Aziz is his brother Yusuf. He plotted with him to keep him in Egypt enjoying honor and great hospitality. A 4\$^ \$ 'f *4 g, 4 oilyi *4. '***£ iAJ A* lit; i>u1j i-fc yw^ ^70. So to/iCTt /iefiimished them forth with their provisions, he put the bowl in his brother's bag. Tlxen a crier cried: "O you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!") 471. They, turning towards them, said: "What is it that you have lost?" 472. They said: "We have lost the bowl of the king andfor him who produces it is (the reward of) a camel load; and I will be bound by it.") Yusufhad His Golden Bowl placed in Binyamin's Bag; a Plot to keepHim in Egypt After Yusuf supplied them with their provisions, he ordered some of his servants to place his silver bowl (in Binyamin's bag), according to the majority of scholars. Some scholars said that the king's bowl was made from gold. Ibn Zayd added that the king used it to drink from, ' and later, measured food grains with it since food became scarce in that time, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhfik and 'Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd. 121 Shu'bah said that Abu Bishr narrated that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn 'Abbas said that the king's bowl was made from silver and he used it to drink with. I3' Yusuf had the bowl placed in Binyamin's bag while they were unaware, and then had someone herald, ,!| At-Tabari 16:172. At-Tabari 16:173. AMabari 16:176.

J ttt m\$m ' -tf-r-"" .i-~ fiv Y (j 4 ji 2 j »:Hit \P\$b&jit3p iS-U.aJ j . X.fl fl) 1j)li JLAA>1^1^ -^, uji jJfjji<4-*p4 >./ llcj3d SSaaiilu 40 you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!) Theylooked at theman whowas heralding this statement and asked him, JiAju ij!i tv^^yip IjU^ jf Jjj'fT, (4-^ii> Jcjj3 J_j^ Iujitbo^Uuii,jyfa'gdj&L±}&j ol'S* (-5j4^=\3>»J *4-jj4 <3^02 -Lii ir 4 W // ^ t/ /*/ > J1'uIl4!i *,l *, \ .All4^---, . !*, 4op' i"What is it that you have lost?" They said: "We have lost the bowl of tte king..."), which he used to measure food grains, 4y^& 'i it iand for him who produces it is a camel load;), as a reward, i'-^j **t iand I will be bound by it.), as assurance of delivery of the reward. A&A Hi lju ;,vrfjcifl* £ Cj jej'ii j Ju2j Hi; u j3j «iG Jpf yp *4p> 4 Pj ji y>I ui tjSf -liU'-jiT A—J *Wj j* 4p .Wj 4:* > Lk_i itiJ o* Ilij <'p)i yJJ 4 *ti-5 ji-tj H 4®>-P? ^4 ^=- A>j ^73. They said: "By Allah! Indeed you know that we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!") 474. They said: "What then shall be the penalty ofhim, ifyou are (proved to be) liars.") 475. They [Yusufs brothers] said: "His penalty should be that

192 — Tafsir Ibtī Katlur he, in whose bag it is found, should be held for the punishment (of the crime). Thus we punish the wrongdoers!" *76. So he [Yusuf] began (the search) in their bags before the bag of his brother. Then he brought it out of his brother's bag. Thus did We plan for Yusuf. He could not take his brother by the law of the king (as a slave), except that Allah willed it. We raise to degrees whom We will, but over all those endowed with knoioledge is the All-Knowing (Allah). After Yusuf's servants accused his brothers of theft, they said, iBy Allah ! Indeed you bww that we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!) Ever since you knew us, you, due to our good conduct, became certain that, \t Cj 4 1J4 ILL. iioe came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!) They said, Theft is not in our character, as you came to know.' Yusuf's men said, £>) 'iWhat then shall be the penalty ofhim), in reference to the thief, if it came out that he is one ofyou,' iifyou are (proved to be)

liars?) They asked them, What should be the thieves punishment if he is one of you?' 4 4 jJ,& \)H) 4They said "His penalty should be that he, in whose bag it is found, should be held for the punishment. Thus we punish the wrongdoers!") This was the law of Prophet Ibrahim, peace be upon him, that the thief be given as a slave to the victim of theft. This is what Yusuf wanted, and this is why he started with their bags first before his brother's bag, to perfect the plot, 4*~£ y)

793 Surah 72. Yusuf (73- 6) (Part- 13) iThen he brought it out of his brother's bag .) Therefore, Yusuf took Binyamin as a slave according to their judgement and the law which they believed in. So Allah said; iThus did We plan for Yusuf.) and this is a good plot that Allah likes and prefers, because it seeks a certain benefit using wisdom and the benefit of all. Allah said next, iHe could not take his brother by the law of the king,) as a captive, for this was not the law of king of Egypt, according to Ad-Dahhak and several other scholars. 1,1 Allah only allowed Yusuf to take his brother as a captive after his brothers agreed to this judgement beforehand, and he knew that this was their law. This is why Allah praised him when He said, 4We raise to degrees whom We will,) just as He said in another Ayah, 4££-^ gri) iAllah will exalt in degree those of you who believe.) [58:11] Allah said next, 4i-Jf Jyj) ibut over all those endowed with knowledge is the All- Knowing Al-Hasan commented, "There is no knowledgeable person, but there is another person with more knowledge until it ends at Allah the Exalted and Most Honored. 121 In addition, 'Abdur- Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, "We were with Ibn 'Abbas when he narrated an amazing Hadith. A man in the audience said, 'All praise is to Allah! There is an all-knowing above every person endowed with knowledge.' Ibn 'Abbas responded, Worse it is that which you said! Allah is the All- At-Tabari 16:188. At-Tabari 16:193.

beforehand, meaning YQsuf, peace be upon him! Allah said, 4 '-HJi these things did Yusuf keep in himself meaning the statement that he said afterwards, IL iijj jJL 4Vow are in an evil situation, and Allah is the Best Knower of that which you describe!} YQsuf said this to himself and did not utter it aloud, thus intending to hide what he wanted to say to himself even before he said it. Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4*^r* <i * **£ iBut these things did Yusuf keep in himself "He kept in himself [his statement next], q ft% \<k=£. *£ iYou are in an evil situation, and Allah is the Best Knower of that which you describe!}." u q ca& <jg (242. a k \$\$ fry "S) id. j*q ji-ll J *it iC jli |v| Ji£c_»iKj 478. They said: "O 'Aziz! Verily, he has an old father (who will grieve for him); so take one of us in his place. Indeed we think that you are one of the doers of good."} 479. He said: "Allah forbid, that we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property. Indeed (if we did so); we should be wrongdoers."} Yusuf's Brothers offer taking One of Them instead of Binyamin as a Slave, Yusuf rejects the Offer When it was decided that Benjamin was to be taken and kept with YQsuf according to the law they adhered by, Yusuf's brothers started requesting clemency and raising compassion in his heart for them, 4<j£Cl 0A k&R

iThey said, "O 'Aziz! Verily, he has an old father..."} who loves him very much and is comforted by his presence from the son that he lost, 4jAit£==v. bji4 XAA} so take one of us in his place.}, instead of Binyamin to remain with you, ije—dS j ilndeed toe think that you are one of the doers of good.}, the good doers, just, and accepting fairness, 4- ji-'d J «ii jli^ iHe said: "Allah forbid, that toe should take anyone but him with whom we found our property..."}, 'according to the judgement that you gave for his punishment, id>j jS lit %} ^ lii T£o s&sm Vi S^C' 'jWjJk-ju \ |>JbJ\-.^ =3J If > > d.-. '/// / -*•' Aj—"

viiljj Ijli i ^jAA 4 444 ^ 'S~*J f.'A o)>~j^Jla0dxJ^AL^ lj\ jjls j^i "'jL-LJi G->»kf>^430j.>JL^ al 441jCilD\ju\$ •JG ip—aj Aiilj i f- ilndeed, we should be wrongdoers.}, if we take an innocent man instead of the guilty man.' lit s> ft dj £L4 pi JS Lii ** b^iGI ji^; jl G)i '4 <->it 4»- qS\ ffi 4 i-dpi £ jei Jy Allt ji Liip t*j \ du4j Ipjii 44-i 41 4*/4 .A*, _/w- 4 At1 ' £ (!&=. Ji i;>'i 4Sij :*t;Svu4. u; o; c &, £jj £fi uui 44b

480. So, when they despaired of him, they consulted in private. The eldest among them said: "Know you not that your father did take an oath from you in Allah's Name, and before this you did fail in your duty with Yusuf. Therefore I will not leave this land until my father permits me, or Allah decides my case and He is the Best of the judges. 481 . "Return to your father and say, 'O our father! Verily, your son has stolen, and toe testify not except according to what toe know, and we could not know the Unseen!y 482. "And ask (the people of) the town where we have been, and the caravan in which we returned; and indeed we are telling the truth."y Yusuf's Brothers consult Each Other in Confidence; the Advice Their Eldest Brother gave Them Allah narrates to us that Yusuf's brothers were desperate because they could not secure the release of their brother Binyamin, even though they had given a promise and sworn to their father to bring him back. They were unable to fulfill their promise to their father, so, 4in private, away from people's eyes, 4\S#y 4they consulted, among themselves, 4The eldest among them said, and his name, as we mentioned, was Ruben, or Yahuda. He was the one among them who recommended throwing Yusuf into a well, rather than killing him. So Ruben said to them, at '4Know you not that your father did take an oath from you in Allah's Name,y that you will return Binyamin to him? However, you were not able to fulfill this promise and, before you caused Yusuf to be lost from his father,

198 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ^\$} {Therefore I will not leave this land}, I will not leave Egypt, {until my father permits me,} allows me to go back to him while he is pleased with me, O ii> 'fi \$} {or Allah decides my case^ by using the sword, or, they say; by allowing me to secure the release of my brother, {turn £ %} {and He is the Best of the judges.}, He next ordered them to narrate to their father what happened so that they could present their excuse about that happened to Binyamin and as claim their innocence before him. Ruben said to them (to say to their father), {and we could not know the Unseen!} or, "we did not know that your son had committed theft," according to Qatadah and 'Ikrimah.' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that it means, 'Sve did not know that Binyamin stole something that belonged to the king, we only stated the punishment of the thief,' {And ask (the people of) the town where we have been,}, in reference to Egypt,'2 ' according to Qatadah,'3 ' or another town. {and the caravan in which we returned.}, 'about our truthfulness, honesty, protection and sincere guardianship, £jj} At-Tabari 16:211-212. ' At-Tabari 16:210. ' At-Tabari 16:212.

199 Surah 12. Yusuf (83-86) (Part-13 and indeed we are telling the truth.) in what we have told you, that Binyamin stole and was taken as a captive as compensation for his theft.' J-* S-& oJp £ c— djjj JLjiJI oJG jl Ui/>- . viijj ^=>j: ly^jj «IilS i^Ul ji» ^ U <L' iJCil Ol jte iAj'ot^i3 ' 483. He [Ya'qub] said: "Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is most fitting (for me). May be Allah will bring them (back) all to me. Truly, He! Only He is All-Knowing, All-Wise."} 484. And he turned away from them and said: "Alas, my grief for Yusuf!" And he lost his sight because of the sorrow that he was suppressing.} 485. They said: "By Allah! You will never cease remembering Yusuf

until you become weak with old age, or until you be of the dead.”} He said: "I only complain of my grief and sorrow to Allah, and I know from Allah that which you know not."} Allah's Prophet Ya'qub receives the Grievous News Allah's Prophet Ya'qub repeated to his children the same words he said to them when they brought false blood on Yusuf shirt, 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is most fitting (for me).} Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "When they went back to Ya'qOb and told him what happened, he did not believe them and thought that this was a repetition of what they did to Yusuf. So he said, 4U: <A p oEl& 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something.

So patience is mostfitting {for me).} Some said that since this new development came after what they did before [to Yusuf], they were given the same judgement to this later incident that was given to them when they did what they did [to Yusuf]. Therefore, Ya'qub's statement here is befitting, iUr cl& 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is mostfitting (for me).} He then begged Allah to bring back his three sons: Yusuf, Binyamin and Rubil to him." ' Rubil had remained in Egypt awaiting Allah's decision about his case, either his father's permission ordering him to go back home, or to secure the release of his brother in confidence. This is why Ya'qub said. iijdi£ jfy ^L; J dSf ji} iMay be Allah will bring them (back) all to me. Truly, He! Only He is All-Knowing,}, in my distress, ithe All-Wise}, in His decisions and the decree and preordainment He appoints. Allah said next, \j} \$And he turned away from them and said: "Alas, my grief for Yusuf!"} He turned away from his children and remembered his old grief for YCisuf, iiji &k} 4Alas, my grief for Yusuf!} The new grief, losing Binyamin and Rubil, renewed his old sadness that he kept to himself. 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ath-Thawri said that Sufyan Al-TJsfuri said that Said bin Jubayr said, "Only this nation [the following of Prophet m At-Tabari 16:214.

Muhammad sg] were given Al-Istirja'P Have you not heard thj statement of Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ji-* ojil' iLLle d* ^d>^ 4"Alas, my grief for Yusuf !" And he lost his sight because of the sorrow that he was suppressing,)" Ya'qab suppressed his sorrow and did not complain to created being, according to Qatadah and other scholars.'3 ' Acl- Dahhak also commented, "Ya'qub was aggrieved, sorrowful and sad."4 Ya'qub's children felt pity for him and said, while feelirj; sorrow and compassion. > > ji 4By Allah! You will never cease remembering Yusuf), "you will keqp remembering Yusuf, 4&Z A) iuntil you become zoeak with old age,), until your strength leaves you,' L> this4pr until you be of the dead They said, 'ifyou continue like we fear foryou that you might die of grief,' 4A x*Aj £>. 4He said: "I only complain ofmy griefand sorrozv to Allah.")Wh£ they stud these words to him, Ya'qub said, iziA-j A- '41 only complain of my grief and sorrow) for the afflictions tl struck me, 4A 4to Allah,) alone, Hat Saying: 'To Allah we belongand to Him shall be our return." '2' 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :227 At-Tabari 16:216. '4 ' At-Tabari 16:218.

202 Tafslr Ibn Kathir tii&M Ttl isauip ^ { > '•!:<!' . t" <>> ? s""!*' '.i*" *-»:;!J d&}ty\5\$ £ £4^42'*sstftsijti \$&Cip\$J6\$<<^ksJi!k==oU l/wuoLJ «yju ' i* ^j'-. *;[££j] ol^Uj^ «^4?-^f*^= != ^\>^y! j <oj£j 'J U^^ i&> 4and I know from Allah that which you know not.} I anticipate from Allah each and every type of goodness.' Ibn 'Abbas commented on

the meaning of, i'opz 1\zjs&iM} land I know from Allah that which you know not.} "The vision that Yusuf saw is truthful and Allah will certainly make it come true."111 « !££2 £3 &£> Cfi \y-\$* Vj i-^rl)

ijtjj £0 Oi S^i Y fj\ \$ f\$ Yl J>\ !£X <\$£ \)£ IJ& '^-. il ^4* ji^uj jS3' 1J s*j^ £*r>* ^J> U*i> \US ^ fti',iiliili 4S7. "O my sons/ Go you and inquire about Yusuf and his brother, and never give up hope of AllSh's mercy. Certainly no one despairs of Allah's mercy, except the people who disbelieve."} 488. Then, when they entered unto him, they said: "O 'Aziz! A hard time has hit us and our family, and we have brought but poor capital, so pay us full measure and be charitable to us. Truly, AllSh does reward the charitable."} HI At-Tabari 16:227.

203Surah 12. Yusuf(87-88) (Part-13 Ya'qub orders His Children to inquire about Yusuf and His Brother Allah states that Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ordered his children to go back and inquire about the news of Yusuf and his brother Binyamin, in a good manner, not as spies. He encouraged them, delivered to them the good news and ordered them not to despair of Allah's mercy. He ordered them to never give up hope in Allah, nor to ever discontinue trusting in Him for what they seek to accomplish. He said to them that only the disbelieving people despair of Allah's mercy. Yusuf's Brothers stand before Him Allah said next. iThen, when they entered unto him), when they went back Egypt and entered upon YOsuf, OS&X [, ithey said: "O Aziz! A hard time has hit us and our family..."), because of severe droughts and the scarcity of food. iand we have brought but poor capital,) means, *we brought money for the food we want to buy, but) it is not substantial,' according to Mujahid, Al-Hasan and several others. Allah said that they said next, 4so pay us full measure) meaning, 'in return for the little money we brought, give us the full measure that you gave us before.' Ibn Mas'Od read this Ayah in a way that means, "So give the full load on our animals and be charitable with us."*2 * Ibn Jurayj commented, "So be charitable to us by returning our brother to us."*3 * And when Sufyan bin TJyaynah was asked if * I * At-Tabari 16:238. * Ibid. * At-Tabari 16:243.

the Sadaqah (charity) was prohibited for any Prophet before our Prophet jg, he said, "Have you not heard the Ayah, i3 i ' j Q ojU 4so pay us full measure and be charitable to us. Truly, Allah does rezvard the charitable.}?" Ibn Janr At-Tabari collected this statement. ^& dSti9a t.&te\$ i\ 'i ill' di>% Jwj Or-i O' Q £4* iill ai fiOj JLiY. '4 Jii -V . L£=> oij U_i ii' a2 iltS ipij 4: r^»%P& J-£& 489. He said: "Do you know what you did with Yusuf and his brother, when you were ignorant?"} 490. They said: "Are you indeed YBsuf?" He said: "I am Yusuf, and this is my brother. Allah has indeed been gracious to us. He ivho has Taqzva, and is patient, then surely, Allah makes not the rezvard of the gooddoers to be lost."} 491. They said: "By Allah! Indeed Allah has preferred you above us, and ive certainly have been sinners."} 492. He said: "No reproach on you this day; may Allah forgive you, and He is the Most Mercifl of those who shoiv mercy!} Yusuf reveals His True Identity to His Brothers and forgives Them Allah says, when Yusuf's brothers told him about the afflictions and hardship, and shortages in food they suffered from in the aftermath of the drought that struck them, and he remembered his father's grief for losing his two children, he felt compassion, pity and mercy for his father and brothers. He felt this way, especially since he was enjoying kingship, authority and power, so he cried and revealed his true identity to them when he asked them. At-Tabari 16:242.

205Surah 12. Yusuf (89-92) (Part-13 \$Do you know what you did with Yusuf and his brother, when you were ignorant meaning, "when you separated between Yusuf and his brother,' i & Si> 4iohen you iverc ignorant?} He said, "What made you do this is your ignorance of the tremendous sin you were about to commit.' It appears, and Allah knows best, that Yusuf revealed his identity to his brothers only then by

Allah's command, just as he hid his identity from them in the first two meetings, by Allah's command. When the affliction became harder, Allah sent His relief from that affliction, just as He said He does, v/ * > ~ 4 i i~t s-& c ^ w. c 4 Verily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief.94:5-6) This is when they said to Yusuf, 4Are you indeed Yusuf?}, in amazement, because they had meeting him for more than two years while unaware of who! really was. Yet, he knew who they were and hid this news from them. Therefore, they asked in astonishment, ijf\ iii; jaa 36 3AA dZfr been he omfn 4Are you indeed Yusuf? He said : "I am Yusuf, and this is my brother. .."} Yusuf said next, 4 iii '4Allah has indeed been gracious to us.} by gathering us together after being separated all this time,' blti ivJ' jjA Y ill' TAA tfc1 iCJk i\ 4" Verily, he who has Taqwa, and is patient, then surely, Allah makes not the reward of the gooddoers to be lost." They said: "By Allah! Indeed Allah has preferred you above us."} They affirmed Yusuf's virtue above them, being blessed with

beauty, conduct, richness, kingship, authority and, above all, prophethood. They admitted their error and acknowledged that they made a mistake against him, 4He said: "No reproach on you this day."} He said to them, There will be no blame for you today or admonishment, and I will not remind you after today of your error against me.' He then multiplied his generosity by invoking Allah for them for mercy, imay Allah forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy!} ' S } ^ \\\} A# ol Vjj jxLJ,y4 ji ft ^51 *13 iljj 493 . "Go with this shirt of mine, and cast it over the face of my father, his vision will return, and bring to me all your family"} 494. And when the caravan departed, their father said: "I do indeed sense the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me not senile)" 495. They said: "By Allah! Certainly, you are in your old Dalai (error)."} Ya'qub finds the Scent of Yusuf in his Shirt! YOsuf said, Take this shirt of mine, 4'h?> cX cjt }Lj Je •_\$_%} 4and cast it over the face of my father, his vision will return}, because Ya'qub had lost his sight from excessive crying, 4^X\ 4and bring to me all your family.} all the children of Ya'qOb. 4And when the caravan departed} from Egypt,

it their father said...}, Ya'qub, peace be upon him, said to the children who remained with him, 'il do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me not senile.}, except that you might think me senile because of {old age.' 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the caravan departed (from Egypt), a wind started blowing and brought the scent of Yusuf's shirt to Ya'qub. He said, il do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me not senile.} He found his scent from a distance of eight days away!" Similar was also reported through Sufyan Ath-Thawri and Shu'bah and others reported it from Abu Sinan.¹²¹ Ya'qub said to them, ijtg. ol H}} if only you think me not senile.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ata, Qatadah and Said bin Jubayr commented, "If only you think me not a fool!"¹³¹ Mujahid and Al-Hasan studied that it means, "If only you think me not old."*⁴¹ Their answer to him was, &\} iCertainly, you are in your old Dalai.} meaning, 'in your old error,' according to Ibn 'Abbas.¹⁵¹ Qatadah commented, "They meant that, "because of your love for Yusuf you will never forget him.' So they uttered a harsh word to their father that they should never have uttered to 111 'Abdur-Razzaq 2:329. ¹²¹ At-Jabari 16:250. ¹³¹ At-Tabari 16:253. At-Jabari 16:255. ¹⁵¹ At-Jabari 16:257.

20S Tafsir Ibn Kathir him, nor to a Prophet of Allah." Similar was said by As-Suddi and others. ¹²¹ \$ Cli p^ pj'1 Jli LiJ—W jjjE ;u jl Qi)s> Jp 3b \$T L>i u ipu y u i ^ >4 5;^ Then, when the bearer of the good news arrived, he cast it (the shirt) over his face, and his vision returned. He said: "Did I not say to you, 7 know from Allah that which you know not?"} 497. They said: "O our father! Ask for forgiveness

(from Allah) for our sins, indeed we have been sinners.”} 498. He said: "I will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you, verily, He! Only He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful."} Yahudha brings Yusuf's Shirt and Good News Ibn 'Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said; good news} means information. Mujahid and As-Suddi said that the bearer of good news was Yahudha, son of Ya'qub.¹³¹ As-Suddi added, "He brought it (Yusuf's shirt) because it was he who brought Yusuf's shirt stained with the false blood. So he liked to erase that error with this good act, by bringing Yusuf's shirt and placing it on his father's face. His father's sight was restored to him."¹⁴ Ya'qub said to his children, "I did not say to you, know from Allah that which you know not?", that I know that Allah will return Yusuf to me and that. ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 16:257. ¹²¹ Ibid. ¹³¹ At-Tabari 16:258. * At-Tabari 16:259.

Y IV - /- > „ ijLi ^ ^j\ ^ol\ xu.plLib jjj 'jJ^AiZ— bLli V_ ^3u>- J\5ja_>^ 2S_)^*- >—iijj j \j-*)J?j-*)l,Je _j^ jj »Liioj. Wd*--Ai JjjIjIjsOubjJISj Ijwjtj .dj -Aijli>-4-> yj\$\$.^^_dJLiJj; ^y^%b%44yj\j^jl>\ vj-wJ' dJl'i1^3uw^is fjpuo>jl> '-^—^> yv.y=>1Uj i© 4f do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me to be senile.} Yusuf's Brothers feel Sorry and Regretful This is when Yusuf's brothers said to their father, with humble-ness, "O my father! Ask forgiveness (from Allah) for our sins, indeed we have been sinners." He said: "I will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you, verily, He! Only He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful."} and He forgives those who repent to Him. 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Ibrahim At-Taymi, 'Amr bin Qays, Ibn Jurayj and several others said that Prophet Ya'qub delayed fulfilling their request until the latter part of the night. . • <Ji' iti _r-^ JUj *oi^ 3 *-f ff. b^j '- l. '« WW -1* br* ui eri*J <b^j^ v*y /A cf^j-AA Je *L>y\ o' f*i bt ^ ffj »Vj ot JI O. 0—*^ ->ij li>- Jj > ft :t£ ti JLt£ j; \ c£-i £ -44i> 499. Then, when they came in before Yusuf, he took his At-Tabari 16 :262

²¹⁰ Tafsir Ibn Kathir parents to himself and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allah wills, in security."} ⁴¹⁰⁰. And he raised his parents to the 'Arsh and they fell down before him prostrate. And he said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My Lord has made it come true! He was indeed good to me, when He took me out of the prison, and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin life, after Shaytan had sown enmity between me and my brothers. Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He wills. Truly, He! Only He is the All-Knowing, the All-Wise.} Yusuf welcomes His Parents; His Dream comes True All&h states that Ya'qub went to Yusuf in Egypt. Yusuf had asked his brothers to bring all of their family, and they all departed their area and left Kana'an to Egypt. When Yusuf received news of their approach to Egypt, he went out to receive them. The king ordered the princes and notable people to go out in the receiving party with Yusuf to meet Allah's Prophet Ya'qub, peace be upon him. It is said that the king also went out with them to meet Ya'qub. Yusuf said to his family, after they entered unto him and he took them to himself, and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allah wills, in security."} He said to them, 'enter Egypt', meaning, "reside in Egypt", and added, "if Allah wills, in security", in reference to the hardship and famine that they suffered. Allah said next, ify) &*) and he took his parents to himself} As-Suddi and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his parents were his father and maternal aunt, as his mother had died long ago²¹ Muhammad bin Ishaq and Ibn At-Tabari 16:267. At-Tabari 16:269.

Jarir At-Tabari said, "His father and mother were both alive.f' Ibn Jarir added, "There is no evidence that his mother had died before then. Rather, the apparent words of the Qur'an testify that she was

alive.” This opinion has the apparent and suitable meaning that this story testifies to. Allah said next, j* £>y} '£»} 4And he raised his parents to Al-'Arsh^ he raised them to his bedstead where he sat, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and several others.¹² ' Allah said, ife. a\$%} 4and they fell down before him prostrate.} Yusuf's parents and brothers prostrated before him, and they were eleven men, <35«as us m 4And he said : “O my father! This is the Ta'wil (interpretation) of my dream aforetime...”, in reference to the dream that he narrated to his father before, 4<&& £1 41 saw (in a dream) eleven stars...} In the laws of these and previous Prophets, it was allowed for the people to prostrate before the men of authority, when they met them. This practice was allowed in the law of Adam until the law of Isa, peace be upon them, but was later prohibited in our law. Islam made prostration exclusively for Allah Alone, the Exalted and Most Honored. The implication of this statement was collected from Qatadah and other scholars.¹³ When Mu'adh bin Jabal visited the Sham area,¹⁴ ' he found them prostrating before their priests. When he returned (to Al- 111 At-Tabari 16:267. ' Ibid. 131 At-Tabari 16:269. ' Greater Syria, which now comprises Syria, Lebanon, Palestine and Jordan

iHe was indeed good to me, when He took me out of the prison, and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin life,} out of the desert, for they lived a bedouin life and raised cattle, according to Ibn Jurayj and others. ' He also said thjat they used to live in the Arava, Ghur area of Palestine, Greater Syria. Yusuf said next, d JLd jj h l*1> iafter Shaytan had soivn enmity between me and my brothers. Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He luills.} for when Allah wills something, He brings forth its reasons and elements of existence, then wills it into existence and makes it easy to attain, iTruly, He! Only He is the All-Knowing.} what benefits servants, ithe All-Wise.} in His statements, actions, decrees, preordaln- ment and what He chooses and wills. in His <(707 . “My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the] sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of. dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Wali in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim, andjom me ivitlt the righteous.”} Yusufbegs Allah to die asA Muslim This is the invocation of Yusuf, the truthful one, to his Lord the Exalted and Most Honored. He invoked Allah after His favor was complete on him by being reunited with his parents and brothers, after He had bestowed on him prophethood and kingship. He begged his Lord the Exalted and Ever High, that At-Tabari 16:276.

235Surah 12. Yusuf (102-104) (Part-13 the unseen incidents of the past, O Muhammad, iwhich We reveal to you.} and inform you of, O Muhammad, because it carries a lesson, for you to draw from and a reminder to those who defy you.' Allah said next, i^-\$ cf} 'iYou were not (present) with them}, you did not witness thleir conference nor saw them, I ip£3 iwhen they arranged their plan together,} well, to throw Yusuf into the <5*8& iand (while) they were plotting} against him. We taught you all this through Our Revelation which We sent down to you. Allah said in other Ayat, ipti k ss Cj} iYou were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens..} and, d[I'u .int iAnd you were not on the western side, when We made clear to Musa the commandment...} [28:44] until, i&A ij jj£ii C,} iAnd you were not at the side of the Tur when We die' call.>[28:46] Allah also said, p* [A -ofJU LjjI; Cj} iAnd you were not a dweller among the people of Madyanl reciting Our verses to them.} [28:45] I Allah states that Muhammad is His Messenger and that He has taught him the news of what occurred in the past, which

carry lessons for people to draw from, so that they acquire their safety in their religious affairs as well as their worldly affairs. Yet, most people did not and will not believe, so Allah said, iAnd most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.\$ Allah said in similar Ayat, iAnd ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they zoill mislead youfar awayfrom Allah’s path} [6:116], and, iVerily, in this is an Ayah, yet most of them are not believers.} [26:8] Allah said next, U Cj} iAnd no reward you ask of themfor it;} Allah says, “You, O Muhammad, do not ask them in return for this advice and your call to all that is good and righteous, for any price or compensation for delivering it. Rather, you do so seeking Allah’s Face and to deliver good and sincere advice to His creatures, il ji iit (the Qur’an) is no less than a Reminder unto the ‘Alamm (men and Jinn)} with which they remember, receive guidance and save themselves in this life and the Hereafter.’ Lstfi l vjgjojoyj’ V* j Ot toitSJ & py cS 533 \$% jL lSfcJ X’ZS* “V. ’ - 1105. And how many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom.} 1106. And most of them believe not in Allah except that they

attribute partners unto Him.} \$107. Do they then feel securefrom the coming against them of the covering veil of the torment of Allah, or of the coming against them of the (Final) Hour, all of a sudden while they perceive not?)? People neglect to ponder the Signs beforeThem Allah states that most people do not think about His signs and proofs of His Oneness that He created in the heavens and earth. Allah created brilliant stars and rotating heavenly objects and planets,- all made subservient. There are many plots of fertile land next to each other on earth, and gardens, solid mountains, lively oceans, with their waves smashing against each other, and spacious deserts. There are many live creatures and others that have died; and animals, plants and fruits that are similar in shape, but different in taste, scent, color and attributes. All praise is due to Allah the One and Only, Who created all types of creations, Who Alone will remain and last forever. It is He Who is unique in His Names and Attributes. Allah said next, iAnd most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him.} Ibn ‘Abbas commented, “They have a part of faith, for when they are asked, Who created the heavens? Who created the earth? Who created the mountains?’ They say, ‘Allah did.’ Yet, they associate others with Him in worship.”¹¹¹ Similar is said by Mujahid, ‘Ata, ‘Ikrimah, Ash-Sha’i, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.¹²¹ In the Sahih, it is recorded that during the Hajj season, the idolaters used to say in their Talbiyah: “Here we rush to Your service. You have no partners with You, except a partner with You whom You own but he owns not!”^{*31} Allah said in another Ayah, At-Tabari 16:292. Ibid. Muslim 2:843.

d\} iVerily , joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zultn (wrong) indeed.> [31:131 This indeed is the greatest type of Shirk, associating others with Allah in worship. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ad said, “I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! What is the greatest sin?’ He said, if «That you call a rival to Allah while He alone created you.n”¹¹ Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on Allah’s statement, iAnd most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him.} “This is the hypocrite; if he performs good deeds, he does so to show off with the people, and he is an idolator while doing this.” Al-Hasan was referring to Allah’s statement, 4:v,yui "is 'M S-d iVerily, the hypocrites seek to deceive Allah, but it is He Who deceives them. And when they stand up for As-Salah, they stand with laziness and to be seen of men, and they do not remember Allah but little.} [4:142] There is another type of hidden Shirk that most people are unaware of. Hammad bin Salamah narrated that ‘Asim bin Abi An-Najfid said that ‘Urwah said, “Hudhayfah visited an ill man and saw a rope tied

around his arm, so he ripped it off while reciting, / V •> if >K • \ > • i And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him.} In a Hadith, from Ibn “Umar collected by At-Tirmidhi who said 111 FathAl-BQri 8:350, Muslim 1 :90.

it was Hasan, the Prophet sg said, JLb 4ll i^i]^ ^jAI «He who swears by other than Allah , commits Shirk.s' 11 Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud and other scholars of Hadith narrated that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'Qd said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Ipj 'fi&h'j Jj Ji ^Verity, Ar-Ruqd, At-Tama'im and At-Tiwaiah are all acts of Shirk.*™ In another narration collected by Ahmad and Abu Dawud,

the Prophet said, ii £\$33 iL S>JH « Verily, At-Tiyarah [omen] is Shirk; everyone might feel a glimpse of it, but Allah dissipates it with Tawakkulj™ ”|4' Allah said next, 4Do they then feel secure from the coming against them of the covering veil of the torment ofAllah?} Allah asks, Do these idolaters who associate others with Allah in the worship, feel secure from the coming of an encompassing torment from where they perceive not?’ Allah said in other ‘Ayat, v vLX « ji ^ 3 ££ J 4*^' Si' .» ^ -s *2^ ^ » *4 J* p-* ul > | ; l i> c| 3' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :135 ™ Ahmad 1:381, Abu Dawud 4:212, Ibn Majah 2:1167. Ar-Ruqd is the act of reciting incantations, charm etc., the lawful type is done with Qur'an . At-Tam&'im is the act of putting an amulet around, the necks of children to save them from the effects of evil eye. At- Tiwalah is a kind ofbewitchment done by those who claim they can cause awoman to be more loved by her husband or vice versa. Reliance on and trust in Him * Ahmad 1 :389, Abu Dawud 4:230.

4Do then those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allah will not sink them into the earth, or that the torment will not seize them from directions they perceive not? Or that He may catch them in the midst of their going to and from, so that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)? Or that He may catch them with gradual toasting (of their wealth and health)? Truly, Your Lord is indeed full of kindness, Most Merciful.4 [16:45-47] and, 'J. J a#* jit 'J et; J jil 'Jfy if^ & vi if [AU1 >;££ U; 4Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing? Did they then feel secure against the plan of Allah? None feels secure from the plan of Allah except the people who are the losers. [7:97-99] s IV*' "£f /<• // > / /• // #4 >: u uj *»' JI j. *« 4108. Say "This is my ivay; I invite unto Allah with sure knowledge, I and whosoever follows me. And Glorified and Exalted be Allah. And I am not of the idolaters."4 The Messenger'sWay Allah orders His Messenger jg to say to mankind and the Jinns that this is his way, meaning, his method, path and Sunnah, concentrating on calling to the testimony that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah alone without partners. The Messenger ggg calls to this testimonial with sure knowledge, certainty and firm evidence. He calls to this way, and those who followed him call to what Allah's Messenger called to with sure knowledge, certainty and evidence, whether logical or

religious evidence, 4And Glorified and Exalted be Allah. This part of the Ayah means, I glorify, honor, revere and praise Allah from having a partner, equal, rival, parent, son, wife, minister or advisor. All praise and honor be to Allah! glorified He is from all that they attribute to Him, oj+ua V ort **1 \ vby1^ «ju 4jJ ^ ^ iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him, and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgivingf [17:44] ufjVf4 >' a# 4-^ oi^ ot £&\$ JS1 ijisi <441 a; / #£. +s > *; 4109. And We sent not

before you (as Messengers) any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships. Have they not traveled in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them? And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who have Taqwa . Do you not then understand All of the Prophets are Humans and Men Allah states that He only sent Prophets and Messengers from among men and not from among women, as this Ayah clearly states. Allah did not reveal religious and legislative laws to any woman from among the daughters of Adam. This is the belief of Ahlus-Sunnah wal-Jama'ah. Shaykh Abu Al-Hasan, 'Ali bin Isma'il Al-Ash'ari mentioned that it is the view of Ahlus-Sunnah wal-Jama'ah, that there were no female Prophets, but there were truthful believers from among women. Allah mentions the most honorable of the truthful female believers Maryam, the daughter of Imran, when He said, $\text{U} \text{£} = \text{£} \text{Vj} \wedge \text{Jj} \setminus \wedge \text{n} \text{Z} 2 ? \wedge$

if oUJ : 4The Messiah [’Isa], son of Maryam (Mary), was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him. His mother was a Siddiqah [truthful believer]. They both used to eat food.) [5:75] Therefore, the best description Allah gave her is Siddiqah. Had she been a Prophet, Allah would have mentioned this fact when He was praising her qualities and honor. Therefore, Mary was a truthful believer according to the words of the Qur’an. All Prophets were Humans not Angels Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on Allah’s statement, Zj) 4And We sent not before you (as Messengers) any but men) “They were not from among the residents of the heaven (angels), as you claimed.”¹¹¹ This statement of Ibn ‘Abbas is supported by Allah’s statements, $\text{O} \text{t} \text{CUM} \text{Ujf}$ 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers, but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets), (25:20] $\wedge \text{Cj} \ \& \text{U:} \ \text{V} \ \text{iJa} \ \& \& \ \text{Zj}$) 4And We did not create them with bodies that ate not food, nor were they immortals. Then We fulfilled to them the promise. So We saved them and those whom We willed, but We destroyed extravagants), (21:8-9] and. $4 \& \text{i} \ \text{cA} \ \text{ZZ} \ \pm \text{X} \ \text{C\$}$) 4Say: "I am not a new thing among the Messengers.") [46:9] m Ad-Durr Al-Mcmthur 4 :595

Allah said next, ifrom among the people of townships}, meaning, from among the people of cities, not that they were sent among the bedouins who are some of the harshest and roughest of all people. Drawing Lessons from the Incidents of the Past Allah said next, iHave they not traveled in the land}, meaning, ‘Have not these people who rejected you, O Muhammad, traveled in the land,’ $4 \rightarrow \text{i} \& \ \text{CjJ}$ ’ Jii \$and seen what was the end of those who were before them?} that is, the earlier nations that rejected the Messengers, and

how Allah destroyed them. A similar end is awaiting all

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2763–2769]

disbelievers. Allah said in another Ayah, iHave they not traveled through the land, and lurve they hearts wherewith to understand?} [22:46] When they hear this statement, they should realize that Allah destroyed the disbelievers and saved the believers, and this is His way with His creation. This is why Allah said, $\text{y\%}$ } \$And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who have Taqiva.} Allah says, ‘Just as We saved the faithful in this life, We also wrote safety for them in the Hereafter, which is far better for them than the life of the present world.’ Allah said in another Ayah, $4 \ \text{r} \ \text{ill!} \ \text{j} \gg 4 \text{-b} \ (\text{VrjAL} \cdot \text{ijuliliJI} \ 4 \text{Verily} \ , \ \text{We} \ \text{will} \ \text{indeed} \ \text{make} \ \text{victorious} \ \text{Our} \ \text{Messengers} \ \text{and} \ \text{those} \ \text{w} \ \text{lw} \ \text{believe} \ \text{in} \ \text{this} \ \text{world's} \ \text{life} \ \text{and} \ \text{on} \ \text{the} \ \text{Day} \ \text{when} \ \text{the} \ \text{witnesses}$

224 Tafstr Ibn Kathir rJl T iA &SM&L dnijJJ4=iVlyij[j>-i j'4Jt>4lI2U_j ^ '^~fr' c-Ot(j>IAs>j s1, ; ? > '>,-' #55* < > *>,——' * > -' * l | •' ', ,, ^ ^ •>" t' ^ 2i^oiLJu-3\Lij jvXjs^jC^Sj^Cjau' w|xOrr*? jvt^ ^W-j"i LjXj^v.vjl tr iul^ jtijUo ^_-lJvii_ijX («-pA^j3<_| K'jtt} |Vp s > •> ;:K '^" sy* * +> s from the people who are criminals \$> will stand forth (i.e. Day of Resurrection). The Day when their ex- cuses will be of no profit to the wrongdoers Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (in Hellfire).) [40:51-52] rjj; ^u; 4 &.> (Vs*^~ !>?* ^~=> -U ff\ " jfrf& 4110. (They were reprieved) until, ivhen the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied, then came to them Our help, and xohomsoever We willed were rescued. And Our punishment cannot be warded off Allah's Prophets are aided by Victory in Times of Distress and Need Allah states that He sends His aid and support to His Messengers, peace be upon them, when distress and hardship surround them and they eagerly await Allah's aid. Allah said in another Ayah, <£ 4 . and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah?" [2:2 14| As for saying of Allah,

4'Jjj ithey were denied) There are two recitations for it. One of them is with a Shadda (meaning: they were betrayed by their people). And this is the way 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, recited it. Al-Bukhari said that TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr narrated that he asked 'Aishah about the meaning of the following verse, i'Until when the Messengers give up hope...), Respice will be granted, is it denied or betrayed? 'Aishah replied, "betrayed.'" TJrwah said, "I said, They were sure that their people betrayed them, so why use the word 'thought?' She said, 'Yes, they were sure that they betrayed them.' I said, iand they thought that they were denied (by Allah))?' 'A'ishah said, 'Allah forbid! The Messengers did not suspect their Lord of such a thing.' I asked, 'So what does this Ayali mean?' She said, 'This Verse is concerned with the Messengers' followers who had faith in their Lord and believed in their Messengers. The period of trials for those followers was long and Allah's help was delayed until the Messengers gave up hope for the conversion of the disbelievers amongst their nation and suspected that even their followers were shaken in their belief, Allah's help then came to them.'"111 Ibn Jurayj narrated that Ibn Abi Mulaikah said that Ibn 'Abbas read this Ayah this way, iand they thought they were denied.) 'Abdullah bin Abi Mulaikah said, "Then Ibn 'Abbas said to me that they were humans. He then recited this Ayah, ol i..even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah?" Yes! Certainly, the m Fath Al-Bari 8:217.

help ofAllah is nearly2:214]” Ibn Jurayj also narrated that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Urwah narrated to him that 'Aishah did not agree to this and rejected it. She said, "Nothing that Allah has promised Muhammad, peace be upon him, but Muhammad knew for certainty that it shall come, until he died. However, the Messengers were tried with trials until they thought that those believers, who were with them, did not fully support them." Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that "Urwah narrated that 'Aishah recited this Ayah this way, jj 'f+S "and they thought that they were betrayed." Therefore, there is another way of reciting this word, and there is a difference of opinion about its meaning. We narrated the meaning that Ibn 'Abbas gave. Ibn Mas'ud said, as Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from him, that he read the Ayah this way, iu titil, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied. 'Abdullah commented that this is the recitation that you dislike. Ibn 'Abbas also commented on the Ayah, iuntil, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied^ "When the Messengers gave up hope that their people would accept their messages, and their people thought that their Messengers had

not said the truth to them, Allah's victory came then, fiUi, iand whomsoever We willed were rescued. Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Ibrahim bin Abi Hamzah [Hurrah] Al-Jazari said, "A young man from Quraysh asked [il At-Tabari 16:307.

Said bin Jubayr 'O, Abu 'Abdullah! How do you read this word, for when I pass by it, I wish I had not read this Surah, iuntil, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied. . .} He said, "Yes, it means, when the Messengers gave up hope that their people will believe in them and those to whom the Messengers were sent thought that the Messengers were not truthful." Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim commented, "I have not seen someone who is called to knowledge and is lazy accepting the invitation, until today! If you traveled to Yemen just to get this explanation, it will still be worth it." Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Muslim bin Yasar asked Said bin Jubayr about the same Ayah and he gave the same response. Muslim stood up and embraced Said bin Jubayr, saying, "May Allah relieve a distress from you as you relieved a distress from me!" This was reported from Said bin Jubayr through various chains of narration. This is also the Tafsir that Mujahid bin Jabr and several other Salaf scholars gave for this Ayah. However, some scholars said that the Ayah, iand thought that they were denied}, is in reference to the believers who followed the Messengers, while some said it is in reference to the disbelievers among the Messengers' nation. In the latter case, the meaning becomes: 'and the disbelievers thought that the Messengers were not given a true promise of victory.' Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Tamlm bin Hadhlam said, "1 heard 'Abdullah bin MasUd comment on this Ayah, iuntil, when the Messengers gave up hope} that their people will believe in them, and their people thought when the respite was long, that the Messengers were not given a true promise."*2 (1 * At-Tabari 16:303. * At-Tabari 16:304.

vJXMi li-W iJji ^ j2^ >?yi »<>• J-.-r»A,J eft t-M' 421 ? . Indeed in their stories, there is a lesson for men of understanding. It (the Qur'an) is not a forged statement but a confirmation of that which zvas before it and a detailed explanation of everything and a guide and a mercy for the people who believe .) A Lesson forMenWho have Understanding Allah states here that the stories of the Messengers and their nations and how we saved the believers and destroyed the disbelievers are, jH ia lesson for men of understanding), who have sound minds, is not a forged statement Allah says here that this Qur'an could not have been forged; it truly came from Allah, ifjK 1 4but a confirmation of that which was before it) in reference to the previously revealed Divine Books, by which this Qur'an testifies to the true parts that remain in them and denies and refutes the forged parts that were added, changed and falsified by people. The Qur'an accepts or abrogates whatever Allah wills of these Books, i}& 4and a detailed explanation ofeverything) Meaning the allowed, the prohibited, the preferred and the disliked matters. The Qur'an deals with the acts of worship, the obligatory and recommended matters, forbids the unlawful and discourages from the disliked. The Qur'an contains major facts regarding the existence and about matters of the future in general terms or in detail. The Qur'an tells us about the Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, and about His Names

and Attributes and teaches us that Allah is glorified from being similar in any way to the creation. Hence, the Qur'an is, *-JJ iSXAf 4a guide and a mercyfor the people who believe with which their hearts are directed from misguidance tel guidance and from deviation to conformance, and with which they seek the mercy of the Lord of all creation in this life and on the Day of Return. We ask Allah the

Most Great to make us among this group in the life of the present world and in the Hereafter, on the Day when those who are successful will have faces that radiate with light, while those whose faces are dark will end up with the losing deal.

Surah 13: Ar-Rad

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The Tafsir of Surat Ar-Ra'd

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2770–2833]

(Chapter -13) Which was revealed in Makkah sg>^OP *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. V Jf\ cgbj 3\$ Ji Hi jJ c4>: Ji; p\ 42. Alif Lam Mim Ra. These are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an), and that which has been revealed unto you from your Lord is the truth, but most men believe not.) The Qur'an is Allah's Kalam (Speech) We talked before, in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah (chapter 2) about the meaning of the letters that appear in the beginnings of some chapters in the Qur'an. We stated that every Surah that starts with separate letters, affirms that the Qur'an is miraculous and is an evidence that it is a revelation from Allah, and that there is no doubt or denying in this fact. This is why Allah said next, ii&\ HC\$) iThese are the verses of the Book), the Qur'an, which Allah described afterwards, iHi ~is&j) iand that which has been revealed unto you), O Muhammad, (&S0x) ifrom your Lord is the truth,) Allah said next, &) ibut most men believe not.) just as He said in another Ayah,

232 Surah 13. Ar-Ra'd (1-2) (Part-13) " ^.>"- u^/iAj_> >> **• <•>"[^ / x "£»< Oi^-^,_)^j^}£jjj>— ^•c-‘ (>i OJ_jl>CU *Jja •-- \\' •' \ ".*' ' T> -*.• i* ••< Jom^jF'V"" }**j ii±r 0 Ij| #^ _\$j o;^' j"~^==^ £- #• ^Awd most o/ mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly. [12:103] Allah declares that even sifter this clear, plain and unequivocal explanation (the; Qur'an), most men will still not believe, due to their rebellion, stubbornness and hypocrisy. j> ju>y vlj^' y Sify 7^ Jfi <>&2 Y fe pi *£ ^ 535 j4£ _>Vt ^2 <^3>V ^ 42. Allah is He Who raised the heavens without any pillars that you can see. Then, He rose above (Istawa) the 'Arsh [Throne]. He has subjected the sun and the moon, each running (its course) for a term appointed. He manages and regulates all affairs; He explains the Ayat in detail, that you may believe with certainty iti the meeting with your Lord .}> Clarifying Allah's Perfect Ability Allah mentions His perfect ability and infinite authority, since it is He Who has raised the heavens without pillars by His permission and order. He, by His leave, order and power, has elevated the heavens high above the earth, distant and far away from reach. The heaven nearest to the present world encompasses the earth from all directions, and is also high

above it from eveiy direction. The distance between the first heaven and the earth is five hundred years from every direction, and its thickness is also five hundred years. The second heaven surrounds the first heaven from every direction, encompassing everything that the latter carries, with a thickness also of five hundred years and a distance between them of five hundred years. The same is also true about the third, the fourth, the fifth, the sixth and the seventh heavens. Allah said, ilt is Allah who has created seven heavens and of the earth the like thereof [65 :12 Allah said next, i..without any pillars that you can see.\$ meaning, 'there are pillars, but you cannot see them,' according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-

Hasan, Qatadah, and several other scholars.*21 Iyas bin Mu'awiyah said, "The heaven is like a dome over the earth," meaning, without pillars.*31 Similar was reported from Qatadah, and this meaning is better for this part of the Ayah,¹⁴ especially since Allah said in another Ayah, o' 4H; withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His permission.^[22 :65] Therefore, Allah's statement, *'' This comes from an authentic narration from Ibn Mas'ud. See Al- 'Ulu (Mukhtasir) p. 103. and Al-Majma' 1 :86. There is also a weak narration attributed to the Prophet saying the same. It was recorded by At-Tirmidhi 2:525, as well as others. At-Tabari 16:324. *31 Ibid. * At-Tabari 16:325.

i..that you can see}, affirms that there are no pillars. Rather, the heaven is elevated (above the earth) without pillars, as you see. This meaning best affirms Allah's ability and power. Al-Istawa», Rising above the Throne Allah said next, iThen, He rose above (Istawa) the Throne.} We explained the meaning of the Istawa' in Surat Al-A'raf (7:54), and stated that it should be accepted as it is without altering, equating, annulling its meaning, or attempts to explain its true nature. Allah is glorified and praised from all that they attribute to Him. Allah subjected the Sun and the Moon to rotate continuously Allah said, ' ifei '\$ \$He has subjected the sun and the moon, each running (its course) for a term appointed.} It was said that the sun and the moon continue their course until they cease doing so upon the commencement of the Final Hour, as Allah stated, 'J {And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed) .}[36:38] It was also said that the meaning is: until they settle under the Throne of Allah after passing the other side of the earth. So when they, and the rest of the planetary bodies reach there, they are at the furthest distance from the Throne. Because according to the correct view, which the texts prove, it is shaped like a domb, under which is all of the creation. It is not circular like the celestial bodies, because it has pillars by which it is carried. 111 This fact is clear to those who I 1 ! See Surat Gh&fir40 :7.

correctly understand the Ayat and authentic Hadiths. All the (praise is due to) Allah and all the favors are from Him. Allah mentioned the sun and the moon here because they are among the brightest seven heavenly objects. Therefore, if Allah subjected these to His power, then it is clear that He has also subjected all other heavenly objects. Allah said in other Ayat, iProstrate yourselves not to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, ifyou (really) worship Him .} [41:37] and, iitm 'M m 4A 0^ &15 ^if; 4!mUX& iAnd (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} (7 :54 Allah's statement next, {He explains the Ayat in detail, that you may believe with certainty in the Meeting with your Lord.} means, He explains the signs and clear evidences that testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. These evidences prove that He will resurrect creation if He wills, just as He started it. jj 4 jty jJ'^ <2 of* ^* J Sifj (uij ot j,k 43. And it is He Who spread out the earth, and placed therein firm mountains and rivers and of every kind offruit He made

Zawjayn Ithnayn (two in pairs). He brings the night as a cover over the day. Verily, in these things, there are Ayat (signs) for people who reflect.} 44 . And in the earth are neighboring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops (fields), and date palms, growing into two or threefrom a single stem root, or otherwise, waiered with the same water; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Verily, in these things there are Ayat (signs) for the people who understand.} Allah's Signs on the Barth After Allah mentioned the higher worlds, He started asserting His power, wisdom and control over the

lower parts of the world. Allah said, %} 4And it is He Who spread out the earth} made it spacious in length and width. Allah has placed on the earth firm mountains and made rivers, springs and water streams run through it, so that the various kinds of fruits and plants of every color, shape, taste and scent are watered with this water, 4s£^ sSrJJ <^=> Oi} iand of every kind offruit He made Zawjayn Ithnayn.}, two types from every kind of fruit, 4#f jit 4He brings the night as a cover over the day.} Allah made the day and night pursue each other, when one is about to depart, the other overcomes it, and vice versa. Allah controls time just as He controls space and matter, 4<3jyfcki liB'i i iVerily, in these things, there are Ayat for people who reflect.} who reflect on Allah's signs and the evidences of His wisdom. Allah said, 4^^j>w jii J»ji\ jj}

iAnd in the earth are neighboring tracts,} Meaning, next to each other, some of them are fertile and produce what benefits people, while others are dead, salty and do not produce anything. This meaning was collected from Ibn 'Abbas Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and several others . This also covers the various colors and types of diverse areas on the earth; some red, some white, or yellow, or black, some are stony, or flat, or sandy, or thick, or thin, all made to neighbor each other while preserving their own qualities. All this indicates the existence of the Creator Who does what He wills, there is no deity or lord except Him. Allah said next, <5g gj Ik1^} iand gardens of vines, and green crops (fields), and date palms...} Allah's statement, next, iSinwanun wa (or) Ghayru Sinwan.} 'Sinwan' means, growing into two or three from a single stem, such as figs, pomegranate and dates. 'Ghayru Sinwan' means, having one stem for every tree, as is the case with most plants. From this meaning, the paternal uncle is called one's 'Sinw' of his father. There is an authentic Hadith that states that the Messenger of Allah ^ said to Umar bin Al- Khattab, Jr-f P* jtOJLz ul» 'Do you not know that man's paternal uncle is the Sinw of his father?*'™ Allah said next, 4 jfZ JZfuj j Xu jll} ^watered with the same water; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat.} At-Tabari 16:331-333. Muslim 2:677.

Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet commented on Allah's statement, 4^=^ 4 of*? 'r iyet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat.} o77ie Dagal/ the Persian, the sweet, the bitter..."»| 21 At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith and said, "Hasan Gharib." Therefore, there are differences between plants and fruits with regards to shape, color, taste, scent, blossoms and the shape of their leaves. There are plants that are very sweet or sour, bitter or mild, fresh; some plants have a combination of these attributes, and the taste then changes and becomes another taste, by Allah's will. There is also some that are yellow in color, or red, or white, or black, or blue, and the same can be said about their flowers; and all these variances and complex diversities are watered by the same water. Surely, in this there are signs for those who have sound reasoning, and surely, all this indicates the existence of the Creator Who does what He wills and Whose power made distinctions between various things and created them as He wills. So Allah said, 4^ iVerily, in these things there are Ayat for the people who understand.} \£Z aij i*. jLJU& tt y4 p zi &V' fw mi 45. And if you wonder, then wondrous is their saying: "When we are dust, shall we indeed then be (raised) in a new creation?" They are those who disbelieved in their Lord! They are those who will have iron cluins linking their hands to their necks. They will be dwellers of the Fire to abide therein forever.} I 1 * These are different dates. ' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :544

Denying Resurrection after Death, is Strange Allah says to His Messenger Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him, J^j) iAnd if you wonder.) at the rejection of the polytheists who deny Resurrection, even though they witness Allah's signs and evidences that He made in His creation which testify that He is able to do everything. Yet, they admit that Allah originated the creation of all things and brought them into existence after they were nothing. However, they deny Allah's claim that He will resurrect the world anew, even though they admit to what is more amazing than what they deny and reject. Therefore, it is amazing that they said, iWhen we are dust, shall we indeed then be (raised) in a new creation?) It is an obvious fact to every sane and knowledgeable person that creating the heavens and earth is a greater feat than creating men, and that He Who has originated creation is more able to resurrect it anew, iDo they not see that Allah , Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is able to do all things)[46 :33] Allah described those who deny Resurrection, 1^ PBS iThey are those who disbelieved in their Lord! They are those who will have iron chains linking their hands to their necks.) They will be dragged in the Fire by these chains, q \$4h) iThey will be dwellers of the Fire to abide therein forever.), for they will remain in Hell forever and will never escape it or be

removed from it. ^ yi 4: a; ^ * j14; ^ 4 Hj ^+4^ j» jj'Sj ^6. They ask you to hasten the evil before the good, while exemplary punishments have indeed occurred before them. But verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind, in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment.} The Disbelievers ask for the Punishment to be delivered now! Allah said, iThey ask you to hasten}, in reference to the disbelievers, iTLZti i} if the evil before the good,} meaning, the punishment. Allah said in other Ayat that they said, U xir 4 <4 c i 4W4&\$\$\$ 4@^ 'h « '4n & uo iAnd they say: "O you to whom the Dhikr (the Qur'an) has been sent down! Verily, you are a mad man! Why do you not bring angels to us if you are of the truthful?" We send not the angels down except with the truth (i.e. for torment), and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!}\15:6-8], and two Ayat; iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment!}\29:53-54] Allah also said, 4A questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall.} [70:1],

<Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the veru truth.\$[42:18], and, 4£k u fk£ !&> iThey say: "Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittana. \$[38:16], meaning, our due torment and reckoning. Allah said that they also supplicated, '_plj >\fy 4And (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth from Yoh.\$>[8:32] They were such rebellious, stubborn disbelievers that they asked the Messenger to bring them Allah's torment. Allah replied, iwhile exemplary punishments have indeed occurred before them . \$ Meaning, We have exerted Our punishment on the previous disbelieving nations, and made them a lesson and example for those who might take heed from their destruction.' If it was not for His forbearance and forgiveness, Allah would have indeed punished them sooner. Allah said in another Ayah, « Vi-i* & b »-J tj- ! iil \$fy 4And if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth.>(35:45) Allah said in this honorable Ayah, jJI Iffy 4But verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. He is full of forgiveness, pardoning and covering the mistakes of people, in spite of their wrongdoing and the errors committed night and day. Allah next reminds that His punishment is severe, so that fear and hope are both addressed and mentioned. Allah said in other Ayat,

4 if % il—1) *jt~j ji [» ^==oJ Jji ilf they belie you, say: "Your Lord is the Owner of vast mercy, and never will His wrath be turned back from the people who are criminals." M6: 147] 4JL4 X*% fcp Ifr iVerily, your Lord is quick in retribution and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.>[7:167], and, 4:g>jVt iiii ji jts%f jLp jjjX gi4 4Declare unto My servants that truly I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment. 15:49-50] There are many other Ayat that mention both fear and hope. 4:r;jU fj X\ i£j £ VjJ i£& cM J 47. And the disbelievers say : "Why is not a sign sent down to him from his Lord?" You are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide.} The Idolators ask for a Miracle Allah states that out of their disbelief and stubbornness, the idolators asked why is not a miracle sent down to the Messenger j§ from his Lord, just like the earlier Messengers? For instance, the disbelievers were being stubborn when they asked the Prophet jj§ to turn As-Safa into gold, to remove the mountains from around them, and to replace them with green fields and rivers. Allah said, 4ojjjVf ^ J Vt sj o' G2: £& 4And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them.>[17:59] Allah said here, 4Yow are only a wamer}, and your duty is only to convey Allah's Message which He has ordered you,

whether it will have a long or a short life. Allah said in other Ayat, m & jrta ij£\$ 4He knows you well when He created you from the earth, and when you were fetuses. [53:32], and, 4He creates you in the wombs of your mother: creation after creation in three veils of darkness.\$[39:6] meaning stage after stage. Allah also said, ') f} 4 ULi &L* Y ot S&![} &£ SjSj\$ } 'J4 fij2S £&, S5£3f tS3££S3^ OT G&S Sfiif 4©*# ' \$23 'if 433 >c i32. 4And indeed We created man out of an extract of clay. Thereafter We made him as a Nutfah in a safe lodging. Then We made the Nutfah into a clot, then We made the clot into a little lump of flesh, then We made out of that little lump of flesh bones, then We clothed the bones with flesh, and then We brought it forth as another creation. So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators. \$[23:12-14] In the two Sahih's it is recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah 3g\$ said, ^ J4 bjfc p tiij; jif ^ jU- jj» 'jjjj *T~^i X'J?* 4\ d-«w jU c tills Jij Jjwai j_j£ **A^*-i» 4 SjaS'J lThe matter of the creation of one of you is put together in the womb of the mother in forty days, and then he becomes a clot of thick blood for a similar period, and then a piece of flesh for a similar period. Then Allah sends an angel who is ordered to write four things. He is ordered to write down his provisions, his life span, his deeds, and whether he will be blessed or wretched." n1 * 1 m Fath Al-Bari 1 1 1486, Muslim 4 :2036.

In another Hadith, the Prophet jg said, Ui Ui 'r'J «—> <3 ikilJLDl «JiiJl 4Js^3 :Jil iThen the angel asks, "O my Lord! Is it a male or a female, miserable or happy, what are its provisions and life span?" Allah then ordains and the angel records it. Allah said next, 4 ltj,} iand by how much the wombs fall short or exceed.} Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, Hit oi- J U jjfc 'i : 'i>\ V! yilL: i iiii >Ji Jc j, fa % \ fuyj ^ajj u J4ul Vl ii-LUl ^ jji*u lS^ cr «77ie Keys of /ie Ghayb (unseen knowledge) are five, nobody knows them but Allah. Nobody knows what will happen tomorrow except Allah; nobody knows what is in the womb except Allah; nobody knows when it will rain except Allah; no soul knows at what place he will die except Allah; and nobody knows when the (Final) Hour will begin except Allah. Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, 4f^>yV' Jorf! tj} iand by how much the wombs fall short}, this refers to miscarriages, ior exceed}, this refers to carrying her fetus in her womb for the full term. Some women carry their fetus for ten months, while others for nine months. Some terms are longer or shorter than others. This is the falling short or exceeding that

Allah the Exalted mentioned, and all this occurs by His knowledge.”131 111 Path Al-B&ri 1 1 :486 , Muslim 4 :2038 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :225 At-Jabari 16:359.

Qatadah commented on Allah’s statement, Y-tJi sCsr ^Everything with Him is in proportion.} “For a term appointed. Allah has the records of the provisions and terms of His creation and made an appointed term for everything.” An authentic Hadith mentioned that one of the Prophet’s daughters sent (a messenger) to him requesting him to come as her child was dying, but the Prophet jg returned the messenger and told him to say to her, jyjaM Uj J»-l{ ‘J***’ ^ t* 4i oj1 "Verily, whatever Allah takes is for Him and whatever He gives is for Him, and everything with Him has a limited fixed tern (in this world), and so she should be patient and hope for Allah's reward . [1 Allah said next, 4All-Knower of the Ghayb (the unseen) and the Shahadah (the witnessable),} Who knows everything that the servants see and all what they cannot see, and none of it ever escapes His knowledge, 4the Most Great}, greater than everything, 4^} 4the Most High.} above everything, 4th&& iCU 4(Allah) surrounds all things in (His) knowledge.}[65:12), and has full power over all things, the necks are under His control and the servants are subservient to Him, willingly or unwillingly. in Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :502

Allah. Verily, Allah will not change the (good) condition of a people as long as they do not change their state (of goodness) themselves. But when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning it back, and they will find besides Him no protector.} Allah’s Knowledge encompasses all Things Apparent and Hidden Allah declares that His knowledge is encompassing all of His creation, those who declare their speech or hide it, He hears it and nothing of it ever escapes His observation. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd if you speak aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and

that which is yet more hidden>[20:7], and, fojC£ C%;) 4And (Alldh) knows what you conceal and what you reveal ‘A’ishah said, “All praise is due to Allah Whose hearing has encompassed all voices! By Allah, she who came to complain about her husband to the Messenger of Allah was speaking while I was in another part of the room, yet I did not hear some of what she said. Allah sent down, Gf 2if ol illj J»\ 4 jj» iif Zf. Ji) * - ilndeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you concerning her husband and complains to Allah. And Allah hears the argument between you both. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.}[58:1] Allah said next, /A •/"V j* Vj? 4whether he be hid by night), in his house in the darkness of the night, *f^j) ior goes forth freely by day.) moves about during the daylight; both are encompassed by Allah’s knowledge. Allah said in other Ayat, 'ofZZ Ow \$) iSurely, even when they cover themselves with their garments.) [1 1:51, and, H bjfi h" i yt ^ Vj ylijj j; dj ijhj Zf) 04 % Jlllf 4 Vj J?ji\ }Ji JVi£ oi cf- v>“ 4 %1 V;M m Al-Bukhari 7385, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 11570, Ibn Majah 188, Af- Tabri 5 :28

^Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an nor you do any deed, but We are witness thereof when you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord (so much as) the a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not what is less than that or what is greater than that but is (written) in a Clear Record.>[10 :61 The Guardian Angels Allah said next, Ju . ^ ~ f * » ^ ft 4For him (each person), there are angels in succession, before and behind him. They guard him by the command of Allah.> Allah states that there are angels who take turns guarding each servant, some by night and some by day. These angels protect each person from harm and accidents. There are also angels who take turns recording the good and evil deeds, some angels do this by day and some by night. There are two

angels, one to the right and one to the left of each person, recording the deeds. The smgel to the right records the good deeds, while the angel to the left records the evil deeds. There are also two angels that guard and protect each person, one from the back and one from in front. Therefore, there are four angels that surround each person by day Eind they are replaced by four others at night, two scribes Eind two gUEirds. An authentic Hadith states, « ! , » * * ' • i ** I***'I I i tJjXSaj .OjlyLi «Angels take turns around you, some at night and some by day, and all of them assemble together at the time of the Fajr and 'Asr prayers. Then those who have stayed with you throughout the night, ascend to Allah Who asks them, and He knows the answer better than they about you, "How have you left My servants?" They reply, "As we have found them praying, we have left them praying FathAl-Bari 13 :426 .

249Surah 13. Ar-Ra'd (12-13) (Part-13 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, * I i ** fSj -iij 'Jl t «Verily, every one among you has his companion from the Jinn and his companion from the angels.” They said, “And you too, O Allah’s Messenger?” He said, •fhi J'A* '4* J&j^13 «.And I too, except that Allah has helped me against him, so he only orders me to dogood .o* 1 * Muslim collected this Hadith)21 Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Ibrahim said, “Allah revealed to a Prophet from among the Children of Israel, ‘Say to your nation: every people of a village or a house who used to obey Allah but changed their behavior to disobeying Him, then He will take away from them what they like and exchange it for what they dislike.” Ibrahim next said that this statement has proof in Allah’s Book, ^ccr" » ^ JL5*i^ _A*>4 - iVerily, Allah will not change the (good) condition of a people as long as they do not change their state (of goodness) themselves • z \ S* it*" ' I/ . "t*, mS (*A> «—"i b* V_fJ -jj-»fr. / ..ST! * ' • ^."T,JUU y>j ft\ 412 . It is He Who shows you the lightning, as a fear and as a hope. And it is He Who brings up the clouds, heavy (ivitlt water). 413. And Ar-Ra'd (thunder) glorifies and praises Him, and so do the angels because of His awe. He sends the thunderbolts, and therewith He strikes whom He wills, yet they (disbelievers) dispute about Allah. And He is Mighty in strength and Severe in punishment.\$ Ahmad 1 :401 I2 * Muslim no. 2814.

Clouds, Thunder and Lightning are Signs of Allah’s Power Allah states that He has full power over Al-Barq (lightning), which is the bright light that originates from within clouds. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas once wrote to Abu Al-Jald asking about the meaning of Al-Barq, and he said that it is water. Qatadah commented on Allah’s statement, ias a fear and as a hope.} “Fear for travelers, for they feel afraid of its harm and hardship, and hope for residents, awaiting its blessing and benefit and anticipating Allah’s provisions.” Allah said next, 4And it is He Who brings up the clouds, heavy.} meaning, He originates the clouds that are heavy and close to the ground because of being laden with rain. Mujahid said that this part of the Ayah is about clouds that are heavy with rain.*2 * Allah’s statement, A jv-fjy 4And Ar-Ra'd (thunder) glorifies and praises Hint}, is similar to His other statement, ui 4And there is not a thing but glorifies His praise.} [17:44) Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibrahim bin Sa'd said, “My father told me that he was sitting next to Hamid bin 'Abdur Rahman in the Masjid. A man from the tribe of Ghifar passed and Hamid sent someone to him to please come to them. When he came, Hamid said to me, ‘My nephew! Make space for him between me and you, for he had accompanied Allah’s Messenger \$&.’ When that man came, he sat between me and Hamid and Hamid said to him, 'What was the Hadith that you narrated to me from the Messenger of Allah ^?’ He said, ‘A At-Tabari 16:387. At-Tabari 16:388.

man from Ghifar said that he heard the Prophet ﷺ say, «Verify, Allah originates the clouds, and they speak in the most beautiful voice and laugh in the most beautiful manner.^ It appears, and Allah has the best knowledge, that the cloud's voice is in reference to thunder and its laughter is the lightning. MQs& bin Ubaydah narrated that Sa'd bin Ibrahim said, "Allah sends the rain and indeed, none has a better smile than it, nor more comforting voice. Its smile is lightning and its voice is thunder." Supplicating to Allah upon hearing Ar-Ra'd (Thunder) Imam Ahmad recorded that Salim bin 'Abdullah narrated that his father said that the Messenger of Allah used to say upon hearing the thunder and thunderbolts. «O Allah! Do not kill us with Your anger, nor destroy us with Your torment, and save us before that."21 This Hadith was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, Al-Bukhari in his book Al-Adab Al-Mufrad, An-Nasal in 'Amal Al-Yawm wal- Laylah, and Al-Hakim in Al-Mustadrak. [3] When 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr used to hear thunder, he would stop talking and would supplicate, "All praise is to He Whom Ar-Ra'd (thunder) glorifies and praises, and so do the angels because of His awe." He would then say, "This is a stern warning to the people of earth." Malik collected this Hadith in Al-Muwatta', and Al-Bukhari in Al-Adab Al-Mufrad.4 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, 111 Ahmad 5:435. 2| Ahmad 2 :100 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :412, Al-Adab Al-Mufrad 187, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :230 , Al-Hakim 4 :286 Al-Muwatta'2 :992 , Al-Bukhari in Al-Adab Al-Mufrad no. 724.

'Your Lord, the Exalted and Most High, said, 'Had My servants obeyed Me, I would have given them rain by night and the sun by day, and would not have made them hear the sound of the Ra'd (thunder).' 1^ Allah's statement, 6* L+j 4He sends the thunderbolts, and therewith He strikes whom He wills,} indicates that He sends thunderbolts as punishment upon whom He wills, and this is why thunderbolts increase as time comes to an end. Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said that Arbad bin Qays bin Juz' bin Julayd bin JaTar bin Kulab, and 'Amir bin At-Tufayl bin Malik came to Al-Madlneh to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and sat where he was sitting. 'Amir bin At-Tufayl said, "O Muhammad! What will you give me if I embrace Islam?"The Messenger of Allah said, u id*} u •You will have the rights and duties of all Muslims .» 'Amir bin At-Tufayl said, "Will you make me your successor if I embrace Islam?" The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «j£ji <A Jjj fjij ij JjuM tThat is not your right, nor your people's right. However, I could appoint you a commander of the horsemen (i.e., war). 'Amir said, "I am already the commander of the horsemen of Najd (in the north of Arabia). Give me control over the desert and you keep the cities." The Messenger of Allah refused. When these two men were leaving the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, 'Amir said, "By Allah! I will fill it (Al-Madlneh) with horses and men (hostile to Muslims)."The Messenger of Allah ﷺ replied, <<i>i «Rather, Allah will prevent you. When 'Amir and Arbad left, 'Amir said, "O Arbad! I will keep m Afimad 2 :359

Muhammad busy while talking to him, so you can strike him with the sword. Verily, if you kill Muhammad, the people (Muslims) will agree to take blood money and will hate to wage war over his murder. Then we will give them the blood money." Arbad said, "I will do that," and they went back to the Messenger ﷺ. 'Amir said, "O Muhammad! Stand next to me so that I can talk to you." The Messenger stood up, and they both stood next to a wall talking to each other. Arbad wanted to grab his sword, but his hand froze when it touched the sword's handle and he could not take the sword out of its sheath. Arbad did not strike the Messenger ﷺ as 'Amir suggested, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ looked at Arbad and realized what he was doing, so he departed. When Arbad and 'Amir left the Messenger of

Allah jg and arrived at Al-Harrah of Waqim area, they dismounted from their horses. However, Sa'd bin Mu'adh and Usayd bin Hudayr came out saying, "Come, O enemies of Allah! May Allah curse you." 'Amir asked, "Who is this with you, O Sa'd?" Sa'd said, "This is Usayd bin Hudayr." They fled until they reached the Riqm area, where Allah struck Arbad with a bolt of lightning and he met his demise. As for 'Amir, he went on until he reached the Kharim area, where Allah sent an open ulcer that struck him. During that night, 'Amir took refuge in a woman's house, from Banu Salul. 'Amir kept touching his open ulcer and saying, "An ulcer as big as a camel's hump, while I am at the house of a woman from Bani Salul, seeking to bring my death in her house!" He rode his horse, but he died while riding it headed to his area. Allah sent down these Ayat (13:8-11) in their case, * &-> U p. iAllah knows what everyfemale bears} until, 4-and they willfind besides Him no protector.} Ibn 'Abbas commented, "The angels in succession, guard Muhammad, peace be upon him, by the command of Allah." He next mentioned the demise of Arbad by Allah's command, reciting this Ayah,

iHe sends the thunderbolts,)" 111 Allah said next, iyet they (disbelievers) dispute about Allah.) they doubt Allah's greatness and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, iXi) %) iAnd He is Mighty in strength and Severe in punishment.) Allah's torment is severe against those who rebel against Him, defy Him and persist in disbelief, according to the Tafsir of Ibn Jarir At-Tabari.²¹ There is a similar Ayah in the Qur'an, i-i'J- 'jf j (j>Sj Sjj&j) '£% 13^ iSo they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation all together.^[27:50-51] 'Ali bin Abi Talib said that, iXlj j.A%) iAnd He is Mighty in strength and Severe in punishment (Al- Mihal)), means, His punishment is severe.³ •to \ F-f j ot 'j/*-' 4 k> '4i£i j* ty il4. For Him is the Word of Truth. And those whom they invoke besides Him, answer them no more than one who stretches forth his hand for water to reach his mouth, but it reaches him not; and the invocation of the disbelievers is nothing but misguidance.) *** At-TabarfLni 10:379-381. A Hadith mentioning some of this story was collected by Al-Bukhari, no. 4091, it does not mention the sayings ofthe Prophet sgz. At-Tabari 16:394. At-Tabari 16:396.

A Parable for the Weakness of the False Gods of the Polytheists 'Ali bin Abi Talib said that Allah's statement, 4For Him is the Word of Truth.} is in reference to Tawhid, according to Ibn Jarir At-Tabari.* 11 Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, and Malik who narrated it from Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir, said that, 4For Him is the Word of Truth.} means, "La ilaha illallah.'W Allah said next, Ji opM J&j} 4And those whom they invoke besides Hitn...}, meaning, the example of those who worship others besides Allah, i'-i jj# JJ\$} 4like one who stretches forth his hand for water to reach his mouth,} 'Ali bin Abi Talib commented, "Like he who stretches his hand on the edge of a deep well to reach the water, even though his hands do not reach it; so how can the water reach his mouth?"¹³¹ Mujahid said about, 4& 4like one who stretches forth his hand} "Calling the water with his words and pointing at it, but it will never come to him this way."¹⁴¹ The meaning of this Ayah is that he who stretches his hand to water from far away, to either collect some or draw some from far away, will not benefit from the water which will not reach his mouth, where water should be consumed. Likewise, those idolators who call At-Tabari 16:398. l2] Ibid. 131 At-Tabari 16:400. •4 > Ibid.

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Af&i !5r**i fJr ot l* J! [>ji 4H<jye they not observed things that Allah has created: (Imv) their shadows incline.} [16:48] !/"* Uii A-j'V ~i -.05' jJ ji ilif j» oJliJt 05 '_0*- A lo?- jO'j Ji ft J-Oj JLiVt jJ55 Ji js 4 " ._r4^' J-rJ' S*J *Cr o>0- *i' Jj Ji" J 426. Say : "Who is the Lord of the heavens and the earth?" Say: "(It is) Allah." Say: "Have you then taken (for xvorship) Aioliyd' (protectors) other than Him, such as have no power eitherfor benefit orfor harm to themselves?" Say: "Is the blind equal to the one who sees? Or darkness equal to light? Or do they assign to Allah partners ivho created the like of His creation, so that the creation seemed alike to them?" Say: "Allah is the Creator of all things; and He is the One, the Irresistible."} Affirming Tawhid Allah affirms here that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, since they admit that He alone created the heavens and the earth and that He is their Lord and the Disposer of all affairs. Yet, they take as lords others besides Allah and worship them, even though these false gods do not have the power to benefit or harm themselves, or those who worship them. Therefore, the polytheists will not benefit or have harm removed from them by these false deities. Are those who worship the false deities instead of Allah equal to those who worship Him alone, without partners, and thus have a light from their Lord? This is why Allah said here, ijili. M Juf- fl jJJ'j cixlii' sf —i Ji ft jfi' Ji js^ 4Say : "Is the blind equal to the one who sees? Or darkness equal to light? Or do they assign to Allalt partners who created the like of His creation, so that the creations seemed alike to them?"} Allah asks, T)o these polytheists worship gods besides Him

(polytheism) and ordering them to refrain from worshipping others besides Allah. They defied their Messengers and rebelled against them, and this is why the word of punishment struck them as a worthy recompense, iAnd your Lord treats no one with injustice (18:49) \$ j Jjc. li UjSi %£. ijG ii. 'CS\ £ o.j)t uu Jtiifj jioi iit 4^ ji 4® a i&i j:dif >r ' e- 417. He sends down waterfrom the sky, and the valleys flow according to their measure, but the flood bears away the foam that mounts up to the surface - and (also)from that (ore) which they heat in the fire in order to make ornaments or utensils, rises a foam like unto it, thus does Allah (by parables) show forth truth andfalsehood. Then, as for thefoam it passes away as scum upon the banks, while that which is for the good of mankind remains in the earth. Thus Allah setsforth parables.} Two ParablesprovingthatTruthremainsandFalsehood perishes This honorable Ayah contains two parables which affirm that truth remains and increases, while falsehood diminishes and perishes. Allah said, 4iu tU' j* Jjfy 4He sends down waterfrom the sky,} He sends rain, 4WjSi cJCj} iand the valleysflow according to their measure,} each valley taking its share according to its capacity, for some valleys are wider and can retain more water than others which are small and thus retain smaller measures of water. This Ayah indicates that hearts differ, for some of them can retain substantial knowledge while others cannot entertain knowledge, but rather sire bothered by knowledge, 4tj; ^

{but the flood bears away the foam that mounts lip to the surface^ of the water that ran down the valleys; this is the first parable. Allah said next, {and (also) from that (ore) ivhich they heat in the fire in order to make ornaments or utensils...} This is the second parable, whereas gold and silver ore is heated with fire to make adornments with it, and iron and copper ore are heated to make pots and the like with it. Foam also rises to the surface of these ores, just as in the case with water, ithus does Allah (by parables) showforth truth andfalsehood.} when they both exist, falsehood does not remain, just as foam does not remain with the water or the gold and silver ores which are heated in fire. Rather, foam dissipates and vanishes, {'Xjur JyJ' iThen, as for the foam it passes away as scum upon the banks,} for

it carries no benefit and dissipates and scatters on the banks of the valley. The foam also sticks to trees or is dissipated by wind, just as the case with the scum that rises on the surface of gold, silver, iron and copper ores; it all goes away and never returns. However, water, gold and silver remain and are used to man's benefit. This is why Allah said next, {while that which is for the good of mankind remains in the earth. Thus Allah sets forth parables.} Allah said in a similar Ayah, Cj tyiii &&& {And these similitudes We put forward for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge.} [29:43]

Some of the Salaf (rightly guided ancestors) said, "When I would read a parable in the Qur'an that I could not comprehend, I would cry for myself because Allah the Exalted says, iBut none will understand them except tlwse wlv have knowledge.}" [29:43] 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, cJci X .Clil cSi iHe sends down water from the sky, and the valleys flow according to their measure,} "This is a parable that Allah has set; the hearts carry knowledge from Him, and certainty according to the amount of doubt. As for doubt, working good deeds does not benefit while it exists. As for certainty, Allah benefits its people by it, hence Allah's statement, iThen, asfor thefoam}, which refers to doubt, 4 J.Q\ £4 u l % XjL 4J,Sj} iit passes away as scum upon the banks, while that which is far the good ofmankind remains in the earth.} in reference to certainty. And just as when jeweliy is heated in fire and is rid of its impurity, which remains in the fire, similarly Allah accepts certainty and discards doubt." The Qur'an and the Sunnah contain Parables that use Waterand Fire Allah has set two examples in the beginning of Surat Al- Baqarah (chapter 2) about the hypocrites, one using fire and smother using water. Allah said, 4fe U isttf ES fit' sffJA rfjlf JS3 m At-Tabari 16:410.

liij dIJ.L j»J Ij* f>4** *}i Uj 4)1 t • ,! ' „, ^jj jjii jIa ju_j "The example of guidance and knowledge with which Allah has sent me is like abundant rain falling on the earth, some of which was fertile soil that absorbed the rain water and brought forth vegetation and grass in abundance. And another portion of it was hard, it held the rain water and Allah benefited the people with it and they utilized it for drinking, grazing, making their animals drink from it and for irrigation purposes. And another portion of it fell on barren land, which could neither hold the water nor bring forth vegetation. The first is the example of the person who comprehends Allah's religion and gets benefit, as well as benefiting others (from the knowledge and guidance) which Allah has revealed through me and learns and then teaches others. The last example is that of a person who does not care for it and does not embrace Allah's guidance revealed through me .i* 1 This parable uses water in it. In another Hadith that Imam Ahmad collected, Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah said, J"- U o;Lii llui \j\S I Jf'j jiu " Lfc? J& Jt ijllll ji- |*la ijllll je. _L>.I til JIS "My example and the example of you is like that of a person who lit a fire. When the fire illuminated his surroundings, butterflies and insects started falling into it, as they usually do, and he started swatting at them to prevent them from falling; but they overwhelmed him and kept falling into the fire. This is the parable of me and you, I am holding you by the waist trying to save you from the Fire, saying, "Go away from the Fire," yet you overwhelm me and fall into itM21 111 FathAl-B£ui 1 :211 , Muslim 4:1788. •2| Ahmad 2:312.

The Two Sahihs also collected this Hadith J This is a parable using fire. -5- 4 U (43 CS' j> <0 ijUlj ^^ pJi 4 V* ylijl •>- >-T*J jA-J Ajm 426. For f/iouse ivho answered their Lord's call is Al-Husna. But those

ivho answered not His call, if they had all that is in the earth together with its like, they would offer it in order to save themselves. For them there will be the terrible reckoning. Their dwelling place ivill be Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.} Reward ofthe Blessed and Wretched Ones Allah mentions the final destination of the blessed ones and the wretched ones, ^rrJ. iFor those ivho answered their Lord's call} obeyed Allah and followed His Messenger (Muhammad, peace be upon him) by obeying his commands and believing in the narrationshebroughtabout the pastand the future, theirs will be, iAl-Husnd}, which is the good reward. Allah said that Dhul- Qamayn declared, AV . 4 f\$ j d) jy m {j 4 u \jff\ j* j! Jjic—j \$ 4As for him who does wrong, we shall punish him, and then he will be brought back unto his Lord, Who will punish him with a terrible torment (Hell). But asfor him who believes and works righteousness, he shall have the best reward (Al-Husna), and we shall speakuntohim mildwordsbyyourcommand}[18: 87-88] Allah said in another Ayah, &31 1^3 iFor those who have done good is the best (Al-Husnd) and even m Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :323 , Muslim 4 : 1790

more.} [10:26] Allah said next, iBut those who answered not His call,} disobeyed Allah, ixLJ: jf}.i\ 4 u iif they had all that is in the earth together} meaning, in the Hereafter. This Ayah says: Had the earth's fill of gold and its like with it, they would try to ransom themselves from Allah's torment at that time. However, this will not be accepted from them. Verily, Allah the Exalted will not accept any type of exchange from, -' iFor them there luill be the terrible reckoning.} in the Hereafter, when they will be reckoned for the Naqu and the Qitmir}2 ^ the big and the small. Verily, he who is reckoned in detail on that Day will receive punishment, hence Allah's statement next. iTheir dwelling place will be Hell; and worst indeed is that placefor rest.} &A jL Jy' yLu il9. Shall he then wlv knows that what has been revealed unto youfrom your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men ofunderstanding that pay heed.} The Believer and the Disbeliever are never Equal Allah says, They could never be equal; those among people who know that what, ihas been revealed unto you}, O Muhammad, The speck on the back ofa date stone. The thin membrane over the date stone

VjtJ> (** iyy-iy U-j £* fde J&l J* (*^ oj'--'* . p4£JL>l j oj £& JO ^ |OV 420. Those who fulfill, the covenant ofAllah and break not the trust.} 421 . And those who join that which Allah has commanded to be joined andfear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} 422. And those who remain patient, seeking their Lord's Face, perform the Saldh, and spend out of that which We have bestowed on them, secretly and openly, and repel evil with good, for such there is a good end.} 423. 'Adn Gardens, which they shall enter and (also) those who acted righteously from among their fathers, and their wives, and their offspring. And angels sluill enter unto them from every gate (saying) :} 424. "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed is the final home!"} Qualities of the Blessed Ones, which will lead to Paradise Allah states that those who have these good qualities, will earn the good, final home: victory and triumph in this life and the Hereafter, 4Those who fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the trust.} They are nothing like the hypocrites who when one of them makes a covenant, he breaks it; if he disputes, he is most quarrelsome; if he speaks, he lies; and if he is entrusted, he betrays his trust. Allah said next, 4And those who join that which Allah has commanded to be joined} they are good to their relatives and do not sever the bond of

kinship. They are also kind to the poor and the needy and generous in nature, irtv iand fear their Lord}, in what they do or do not do of actions and statements. They remember that Allah is watching during all

of this and are afraid of His terrifying reckoning in the Hereafter. Therefore, all their affairs are on the straight path and correct, whether they are active or idle, and in all of their affairs, including those that affect others, 4And those who remain patient, seeking their Lord's Face,} They observe patience while staying away from sins and evil deeds, doing so while dedicating themselves to the service of their Lord the Exalted and Most Honored and seeking His pleasure and generous reward, iand perform the Satah}, preserving its limits, times, bowing, prostration and humbleness, according to the established limits and rulings of the religion, iand spend out of that which We have bestowed on them,} They spend on those whom they are obliged to spend on them, such as their spouses, relatives and the poor and needy in general, iil&j r^} isecretly and openly,} They spend during all conditions and times, whether during the night or the day, secretly and openly, iand repel evil with good} they resist evil with good conduct. When the people harm them they face their harm with good patience, forbearing, forgiveness and pardon. Allah said in another Ayah, @1 hf jjjL Ej}

Jii Ji I4I4I; Cy il)W> ^ iRepel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom and you there zoas enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of tire great portion in this world.} [41:34-35] This is why Allah states here that those who have these good qualities, the blessed ones, will earn the final home, which He explained next, 4'Adn Gardens}, where, 'Adn, indicates continuous residence; they will reside in the gardens of everlasting life. Allah said next, 'iff iand (also) those who acted righteously from among their fathers, and their loives, and their offspring.} Allah will gather them with their loved ones, from among their fathers, family members and offspring, those who are righteous and deserve to enter Paradise, so that their eyes are comforted by seeing them. He will also elevate the grade of those who are lower, to the grades of those who are higher, a favor from Him out of His kindness, without decreasing the grade of those who are higher up (in Paradise). Allah said in another Ayah, (»r rrij* | iAnd those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith : to them shall We join their offspring.} (52:21] Allah said next, / s »> .- -V # < *> >> \ ^ , ' ! Jxc- fjye Uj >Cle Qpyt J» yi pr~ Oji-A, 7 iAnd angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Saldmun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in patience! Excellmt indeed is the fiiral home!"} The angels will enter on them from every direction congratulating them for entering Paradise. The angels will

welcome them with the Islamic greeting and commend them for earning Allah's closeness and rewards, as well as, being admitted into the Dwelling of Peace, neighbors to the honorable Messengers, the Prophets and the truthful believers. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Al-'As, may Allah be pleased with them both, narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, *?}bl jii j* 'Jt Jjl OjjjZ "Do you know who among Allah's creation will enter Paradise first? They said, "Allah and His Messenger have more knowledge." He said, ("£ iijJ' OjyrIfAJl «l>ai 4)1 jU- fj* SUjl ja Jj{» l^J ^ lojlSAAJt jLfc dr*" »LiJ JUj Alt I liiijLw jilw 0^*31^ Uj V iSlrf Ijte\$: - Jli - JLi N ojJLl> ^ JjjIjj iojISUJI ®T7ic first among Allah's creation to enter Paradise are the poor emigrants (in Allah's cause) with whom the outposts (of the land) are secured and the various afflictions are warded off. One of them would die while his need is still in his chest, because he was unable to satisfy it himself. Allah will say to whom He will among His angels, "Go to them and welcome them with the Salam." The angels will say, "We are the residence of Your heaven and the best of Your creation, do You command us to go to them and welcome them with the Salam?" Allah will say, "They are My servants who worshipped

Me and did not associate anyone or anything with Me in worship. With them, the outposts were secured and the afflictions were warded off. One of them would die while his need is in his chest, unable to satisfy it." So the angels will go to them from every gate (of Paradise),* saying,

272 Surah 13. Ar-Ra'd (25) (Part-13 Jr zmm ^ ' ' \ + * > > + < + * * ' ' > > ' -TITTF^ j1 tjrAJlbyiaAifij Aii » Oj££C£ " * — ^ r * jy / }, . ** / , * • > * y / . X ' / \ < . tH - * i - f ' * V J ' X X ? ' * * . ' * C ' X * TV * " ? ' " oyi-jj 4jl(O 4 ^ . 0 ^ ^ . " ; > » , < < a ; ^ v » i _ j j U l \ ^ j j * j i 3 4 U / £ = = y j ' i M 4 U l _ p j j ^ 4 > _ y i the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).) iSalamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in pa- tience! Excellent indeed is the final home!) " • 1 | t i f + * * ' ' > V " r . r \ J m > (j * < i l ' A f r P O j ^ a i - i i / J y ' J T z 4 j < 1 1 i J * \ U ^ j y A u J J * 4 a 1 Z - 4 o f j V ' 4 o j a ~ j u j J - o j > o ' £ . # i i a f £ j i i j l 4 @ ^ 4 2 5 . And those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratifica- tion, and sever that which Allah has com- manded to be joined, and work mischief in the land, on them is the curse, and for them is Characteristics of the Wretched Ones which will lead to the Curse and the Evil Home This is the destination of the Wretched ones and these are their characteristics. Allah mentioned their end in the Hereafter, to contrast the end that the believers earned, since their characteristics were to the opposite of the believer's qualities in this life. The latter used to keep Allah's covenant and join that which Allah has ordained on them to join. As for the former, they used to, • / P < * > 1 > £ f ' s \ X ' ' > \ l ' ' ' , < * " (f i - i k 4 C > J A - j U j O ' A l l ! ^ a \ \ a O J J U U J J - A J C — J U o i f * < 1 1 1 A 4 P O j r ^ ^ t T 1 1 1 Ahmad 2:168.

ibreak the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Allah has commanded to be joined, and work mischief in the land,) An authentic Hadith states that, jU- 3' ' If-j \ij icfjs eJsi- ij j i C l J l ill «The signs of a hypocrite are three: Whenever he speaks, he tells a lie; whenever he promises, he always breaks it (his promise); if you entrust him, he proves to be dishonest." a*1 In another narration, the Prophet jg said, lip jji- iali liJdD "//he enters into a covenant, he betrays it; and if he disputes, he proves to be most quarrelsome. n12 This is why Allah said next. ion them is the curse,) they will be cast away from Allah's mercy, iM £. #) iandfor them is the unhappy home.) the evil end and destination, iTheir dwelling place will be Hell; and luorst indeed is that placefor rest.) [13:18] i26. Allah increases the provision for whom He wills, and straitens (it for whom He wills), and they rejoice in the life of the world, whereas the life of this world compared to the Hereafter is but a brief passing enjoyment.) 111 FathAl-Bari 1:111. [a] Ibid.

Increase and Decrease in Provision is in Allah's Hand Allah states that He alone increases the provisions for whom He wills and decreases it for whom He wills, according to His wisdom and perfect justice. So, when the disbelievers rejoice with the life of the present world that was given to them, they do not know that they are being tested and tried. Allah said in other Ayat, . * * * * • / £ - v r - • > / { > ^ / // t / > // < v V J m . , J L * i x t > * * * ? • ^ t 4 . Do they think that in wealth and children with ivhich We enlarge them. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not. ^ [23:55-56] Allah belittled the life of the present world in comparison to what He has prepared for His believing servants in the Hereafter, • {whereas the life of this xoord compared to the Hereafter is but a brief passing enjoyment.} Allah said in other Ayat, iSay: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is (far) better for him who has Taqwd, and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the amount of a Fatila.} ^ [4:77] and. ' V T i l l I A V J Jr i N a y , you prefer the life of this world, although the Hereafter is better and more lasting.} [87:16-17] Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Mustawrid, from Bani Fihr, said that the

Messenger of Allah said, « - * » *' 1 J* . j> ;Jls , > » , * > , . ci.li ill: «77ie life of the present world, compared to the Hereafter, is just like when one of you inserts his finger in the sea, so let him contemplate how much of it will it carry. m The thin membrane over the date stone

275Surah 13. Ar-Ra'd (27-29) (Part-13) iLet him then bring us an Ayah like the ones (Prophets) that were sent before (with signs)!} (21 :5) We mentioned this subject several times before and stated that Allah is able to bring them what they wanted. There is a Hadith which mentions that the idolators asked the Prophet to turn Mount As-Safa into gold and, they also asked him for a spring to gush forth for them and to remove the mountains from around Makkah and replace them with green fields and gardens. Allah revealed to His Messenger jg: "If You wish, O Muhammad, I will give them what they asked for. However, if they disbelieve thereafter, I will punish them with a punishment that I did not punish any among the 'Alamtn (mankind and the Jinns). Or, if you wish, I will open for them the door to repentance and mercy."The Prophet jg said, zji\ ^c «Rather , open for them the door to repentance and mercy. This is why Allah said to His Messenger ;eg next, icM*4 S3 iSay: "Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides unto Himself those who turn to Him in repentance."} Allah states that He brings misguidance or guidance whether the Messenger jg was given a sign (a miracle) according to their asking or not. Verily, earning the misguidance or the guidance are not connected to the miracles or the lack of them. Allah said in other kyat. iBut neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who believe not.} (10 :101] ly C*** (*r*t jb Y o[} iTrtdy, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.}[10:96-97], There is a Hadith with similar wording recorded byAhmad 1 :?42.

and, 6\$ 'rfl Uj 0 %} ip&k Yj 'if 'XZ1 ol% 4And even ifWe had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they xould not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most ofthem behave ignorantly.} [6:111] Allah said here, o-* Ifcii ,>• j-iu Jif iSay : "Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides unto Himself those who turn to Him in repentance."} meaning, He guides to Him those who repent, turn to Him, beg Him, seek His help and humbly submit to Him. The Believer'sHeart findsComfort in theRemembrance ofAllah Allah said, Jx 4\$ P'-^} iThose who believed, and whose hearts find rest in the remembrance ofAllah.} for their hearts find comfort on the side of Allah, become tranquil when He is remembered and pleased to have Him as their Protector and Supporter. So Allah said, 4f>p\ if 4 Verily, in the remembrance ofAllah do hearts find rest.} and surely, He is worthy of it.

The Meaning of Tuba Allah said, iThose who believed, and xoork righteousness, Tuba is for them and a beautiful place of (final) return.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that Tuba

means, "Happiness and comfort or refreshment of the eye. "I 1 ' 'Ikrimah said that Tuba means, "How excellent is what they earned, |21 while Ad-Dahhak said, "A joy for them."13 ' Furthermore, Ibrahim An-Nakhi said that Tuba means, "Better for them,"*4 * while Qatadah said that it is an Arabic word that means, 'you have earned a good thing.'*51 In another narration, Qatadah said that 'Tuba, for them' means, "It is excellent for them,"*61 iatid a beautiful place of return and final destination. These meanings for Tuba are all synonymous and they do not contradict one another. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that a man asked, "O Allah's Messenger! Tuba for those who saw you and believed in you!" The Prophet sg said, •M ?j*&W Jfa p Jfa p V; jSj Jj& *Tuba is for he who saw me

and believed in me. Tuba, and another Tuba, and another Tuba far he who believed in me, but did not see me. A man asked, "What is Tuba?" The Prophet ﷺ said, Ja' ﷺ »12 S5U Lj'jrr** ^jt 'fa- *A tree in Paradise whose width is a hundred years, and the clothes of the people of Paradise are taken from its bark.^7 ^ Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Sahl bin Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, •IfnJai 'J i5U Iflli j~~j ijt bp • There is a tree in Paradise, if a rider travels in its shade for one hundred years, he would not be able to cross itJ 111 At-Tabari 16:435. Ibid. Ibid. *41 Al-Baghawi 3:18. 151 At-Tabari 16:435. 161 Ibid. m Ahmad 3:71.

Jr tor j>£ry •** •' m . * s*' < ' j*-4> {^J *—>li \$ve .jsj IP^WKj\$ (i&tikx&Kh i^ryuga st^@ts&&'8tfJi 02Wad4j^ 3j^i-l<4v'^ jla,>;,aj dil^VL^u<j*jJ-uljf 1^ ^ iit 0-3' An-Nu'mSn bin Abi 'Ayyash Az-Zuraqi added, "Abu Said Al- Khudri narrated to me that the Prophet ^§ said, jtri >j*- * t#* op >Lilii sijjJi 441^1 u fu Su *There is a tree in Paradise, if a rider travels in its shade on a fast, sleek horse for one hundred years, he would not be able to cross it.J"* 11 In his Sahth, Imam Muslim recorded that Abu Dharr narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said that Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 'r&j\M jj u» 40ln jii!| js c4i»oti Jtj)^ fr'j h^a t/i 'r^?J ^—'13 >4» J*si »h >& uHi dm ,>£ u «0 My slaves! If the first and the last among you, mankind and Jinns among you, stood in one spot and asked Me and I gave each person what he asked, it will not decrease from My dominion, except what the needle decreases (or carries) when entered into the se«.»|21 Khalid bin Ma'ddan said, "There is a tree in Paradise called Tuba, that has breasts that nurse the children of the people of I 1 ' Al-Bukh&ri no. 6552, Muslim no. 2827. * Muslim 4:1994.

279Surah 13. Ar-Ra'd (30) (Part-13) Paradise. Verily, the miscarriage of a woman will be swimming in one of the rivers of Paradise until the Day of Resurrection commences, when he will be gathered with people while forty years of age." Ibn Abi Hatim collected this statement. 4^*1*^* clk=>j 'J* 'A\ v 430. Tims have We sent you to a community before whom other communities have passed away, in order that you might recite unto them what We have revealed to you, while they disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah). Say: "He is my Lord! None has the right to be worshipped but He! In Him is my trust, and to Him I turn."} Our Prophet || was sent to recite and call to Allah's Revelation Allah says, 'Just as We sent you, O Muhammad, to your Ummah, !&3> 4..in order that you might recite unto them what We have revealed to you,} so that you deliver to them Allah's Message. Likewise, We sent others to earlier nations that disbelieved in Allah. The Messengers whom We sent before you, were also denied and rejected, so you have an example in what they faced. And since We sent Our torment and revenge on those people, then let these people fear what will strike them, for their denial of you is harsher than the denial that the previous Messengers faced,' 4ty*& dl I3S j&} 4By Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you.}[16-63] Allah said in another Ayah, Ji? Vj J5»- ijjT U ijl/L*a i &j} ot '&> 5Sf Cb#, 4Verily, many Messengers were denied before you, with

280 Tafslr Ibn Kathir patience they bore the denial and suffering until; till Our help reached them, and none can alter the Words (decree) of Allah. Surely, there has reached you the information (news) about the Messengers (before you).£[6-34], meaning, 'How We gave them victory and granted the best end for them and their followers in this life and the Hereafter.' Allah said next, iwhile they disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah). Allah says, These people, that We sent you to, disbelieve in the Most Gracious and deny Him, because they dislike describing Allah by Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim [the Most Gracious,

Most Merciful].’ This is why on the day of Al-Hudaybiyyah, as Al-Bukhari narrated, they refused to write, “In the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim,” saying, “We do not know Ar- Rahman Ar-Rahim!” Qatadah narrated this words. 12 * Allah the Exalted said, ‘.LiVi jjj 6 Cl tjf-j’ jt id iyof 4Sfli/ : “Invoke Allah or invoke the Most Gracious (Allah), by whatever name you invoke Him, for to Him belong the Best Names.” [17:110] In his Sahih, Imam Muslim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jfa; said, <11 jLi- Jli; iill ilLiS/l CJ- i jjs •The most beloved names to Allah the Exalted are: ‘Abdullah and ‘Abdur-Ralpnan .»*3 * Allah said next, iy,\ ill H Jj y jfr iSay : “He is my Lord! None has the right to be worshipped but He!”} meaning: for I believe in Allah in Whom you disbelieve and affirm His Divinity and Lordship. He is my Lord, there is no * ! * At-Tabari 16:446. *21 Fath Al-Bari 5 :390 * Muslim 3 : 1682

281Surah 13. Ar-Ra’d (31) (Part-13) deity worthy of worship except Him, iln Him is my trust,} in all ofmy affairs, 4^ iand to Him 1 turn.} meaning: to Him I return and repent, for He alone is worthy of all this and none else besides Him. 4JJ df ii ii JU>J' Ojy* jl \j-& Oyi' 'ij ii' ILiJ jj J j*3 !<-£• * _ii& V ii' rti' qlj ^bj'j i!\ ^>15 4 ^n' 431 . And if there had been a Qur'an with ivhich mountains could be moved (from their places), or the earth could be cloven asunder, or the dead could be made to speak (it would not have been other than this Qur'an) . But the decision of all things is certainly with Allah. Have not then those who believed yet known that had Allah untied, He could have guided all mankind? And a disaster will not cease to strike those who disbelieved because of their (evil) deeds or it (i.e. the disaster) settles close to their homes, until the promise of Allah comes to pass. Certainly, Allah breaks not His promise.} Virtues ofthe Qur'an and the Denial ofDisbelievers Allah praises the Qur'an which He has revealed to Muhammad, peace be upon him, and prefers it to all other divinely revealed Books before it, ^ CjjZ. iWj l>\ Jij} 4And if there had been a Qur'an with which mountains could be moved,} Allah says, ‘If there were a Book among the previous Divine Books with which the mountains could be moved from their places, or the earth could be cleaved asunder, or the dead speak in their graves, it would have been this Qur'an and none else.’ Or, this Qur'an is more worthy to cause all this, because of its marvelous eloquence that defies the ability of

283Surah 13. Ar-Ra’d (31) (Part-13) Messenger of Allah jg said, i'J-j 2b,f ^jji Stf uIv, i^iii Jz. 'j*\ u £j\ jjj vi «ua5i iLi; M 5ii h? Ji & «Every Prophet was given (a miracle) the type of which would make (some) people believe. What I was given, however, is a revelation from Allah to me, and I hope that I will have the most following among them (Prophets) on the Day of Resurrection .n 1 * 1 This Hadith indicates that every Prophet's miracle disappeared upon his death, but this Qur'an will remain as evidence for all times. Verily, the miracle of the Qur'an will never end, nor will it become old the more it is read, nor will scholars ever have enough of it. The Qur'an is serious and is not meant for jest; any tyrant that abandons it, Allah will destroy him; he who seeks guidance in other than the Qur'an, then Allah will misguide him. Allah said next, iBut the decision of all things is certainly with Allah.} Ibn 'Abbas commented, “He will only do what He wills and He decided that He will not do that.”*2 ' Ibn Ishaq reported a chain for this, and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari agreed with it. Allah said next, Jt J & (*trW 3 ZtJ' J'ji iAnd a disaster will not cease to strike those who disbelieved because of their (evil) deeds or it settles close to their homes,} because of their denial, disasters will still strike them in this life or strike those all around them, as a lesson and example for them. Allah said in other Ayat, {j» C 152EJ iAnd

indeed We have destroyed towns round about you, and We have shown (them) the Ayat in various ways that they 111 FathAl-Bari 8:619. ' At-Tabari 16:447

284 Tafslr Ibn Kathir might return (to the truth). 46-27], and, iSee they not that We gradually reduce the land (in their control) from its outlying borders? Is it then they who will overcome?\$ [21:44] Qatadah narrated that Al-Hasan commented on Allah's statement, otQ j* jty ior it settles close to their homes, "It is in reference to the disaster." 1 11 This is the apparent meaning here. Al-'Awfi reported that bin 'Abbas said about, iAnd a Qari'ah (disaster) strikes them because of their (evil) deeds'^ "A torment that descends on them from heaven, Q£ ior it settles close to their homes, when the Messenger of Allah sgj camps near their area and fights them." Similar was reported from Mujahid and Qatadah. Ikrimah said in another narration he reported from Ibn 'Abbas that, iQari'ah^ means affliction. These scholars also said that, 4i' iuntil the promise ofAllah comes to pass.^ refers to the conquering of Makkah. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that it refers to the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next, iiezjA& * -if^ m At-Jabari 16:459.

4Certainly , Allah breaks not His promise.} to His Messengers to aid them and their followers in this life and the Hereafter, "Oil 'o\ ill ltfji- 4So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His Messengers. Certainly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution>[14:47] . y y ' » > <"<' y * # ^^ y "y V dA£==> ^ Cri -i^JT 432. And indeed (many) Messengers were mocked at before you but I granted respite to tlwse who disbelieved, and finally 1 punished them. Then how (terrible) wasMy punishment!} Comforting the Messenger ofAllah sg Allah says to His Messenger, while comforting him in facing his people's denial of him, 4^ Ji ^4 &>} "4And indeed (many) Messengers were mocked at before you}, so you have a good example in them. 4but I granted respite to those wlv disbelieved,} deferred their judgment for a term appointed, 4and finally I punished them .}> with encompassing punishment. How did you obtain the news of how I gave them respite and then took them with punishment?' Allah said in another Ayah, CiUi cf dfezsy} 4And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then (in the end) I seized it (with punishment). And toMe is the (final) return (ofall).}[22:48] It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Prophet sg said, lit rJiku ai !>i>

<* Verily, Allah gives respite to the unjust until when He seizes him, He never lets go ofhimj The Messenger jg next recited this Ayah, uj& ui j.) sa rH% ja iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population ofi towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful, (and) severe.\$[1 1:102]m <yj J^r1 ' jji j* Jyi' Si fiZ u % a si^ 433 . is //ten He (Allah) Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned (like any other deity who knows nothing)? Yet, they ascribe partners to Allah. Say: "Name them! Is it that you will inform Him of something He knows not in the earth or is it (just) a show offalse words." Nay! To those who disbelieved, their plotting is made fair-seeming, and they have been hinderedfrom the right path; and whom Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide. There isno SimilaritybetweenAllahand False Deitiesin any Respect Allah said, 4/s then He (Allah) Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned?\$ Allah is the guard and watcher over every living soul and knows what everyone does, whether good or evil, and nothing ever escapes His perfect observation. Allah said in other Ayat. H ,Jjti^ 'i£=* m •,311s . v: x l . ' > .1 iNeither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 : 1997.

nor you do any deed, but we are witness thereof, when you are doing it. [10:61] and Allah said, 'Not a leaf falls, but He knows it.' [6:59] 4 'Aj Ifiiy ji' j* J°H\ tj }\$> Oi ^yfr frAnd no moving creature is. there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposits. All is in a Clear Book. [11:6], iyj o*3j lA o* *Ay*fr frit is the same (to Him) whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day. [13:10] 4<jAj jA frHe knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden. [20:7] and, frAnd He is with you wherever you may be. And Allah is the All-Seer of what you do. [57:4] Is He Who is like this similar to the idols, that the polytheists worship, which can neither hear nor see nor do they have a mind nor able to bring good to themselves or to their worshippers nor prevent harm from themselves or their worshippers? The answer to the question in the Ayah was omitted, because it is implied, for Allah said next, fr^A^fr frYet, they ascribe partners to Allah. fr which they worshipped besides Him, such as idols, rivals and false deities, frSay "Name them!" fr

And We have assigned for them (devils) intimate companions, who have made fair-seeming to them.} Allah said next, if iand they have been hindered from the right path;} Some read with Fatha over the Sad (i.e. wa Saddu), which would mean, 'and they hindered from the right path, feeling fond of the misguidance they are in, thinking that it is correct, they called to it and thus hindered the people from following the path of the Messengers.' Others read it with Damma over the Sad (i.e. wa Suddu), which would mean, 'and they have been hindered from the right path,' explained it this way: because they thought that their way looked fair or correct, they were hindered by it from the right path, so Allah said, if* le % d ii' £>} iand whom Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide.} Allah said in similar instances, iAnd whomsoever Allah wants to suffer a trial, you can do nothing for him against Allah.} | 5:41], and, iff you covet for their guidance, then verily, Allah guides not those whom He makes to go astray. And they will have no helpers. >[16:37] & 0 Sv'j oj hip Cj \jffS idjJ td)t j p} £4& 35 M sj l)Lif Ji iXit [p\ 134. For them is a torment in the life of this world, and certainly, harder is the torment of the Hereafter. And they have no defender (or protector) against Allah.} 135. The description of the Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised: Underneath it rivers flow, its provision is eternal and so is its shade; this is the end (final

290 Tafslr Ibtt Kathir destination) of those who have Taqwa, and the end (final destination) of the disbelievers is Fire Punishment of the Disbelievers and Reward of the Pious Believers Here, Allah mentions the punishment of the disbelievers and the reward of the righteous believers, after describing the Kufr and Shirk that the disbelievers indulge in, 4 ti"j)' iji 4 v'j iFor them is a torment in the life of this world, by the hands of the believers, killing and capturing them, iand certainly, the torment of the Hereafter. which will come after they suffer humiliation in this life, iis harder many times harder. The Messenger of Allah said to those who agreed to Muld'anah} OjaI CjJI • Ass. jU «Surely, the torment of this life, is easier than the torment of the HereafterV2 ' Indeed, and just as the Messenger of Allah stated, the torment of this life ends but the torment of the Hereafter is everlasting in a Fire that is seventy times hot than our fire, where there are chains whose thickness and hardness are unimaginable. Allah said in other Ayat, i :£! £%&% & ig -3 iSo on that Day none will punish as He will punish. And none will bind as He will bind.^[89:25-26], and, / ^ / / ^ ^ / / / / / < / / . V I 1 * The curse invoked when it is believed that the spouse has committed adultery and there are no witnesses . See the Tafsir of Surat An-Nurno 7. 121 Muslim 2:1131.

And for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire. When it (Hell) sees them from a far place, they will hear its raging and its roaring. And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction. Exclaim not today for one destruction, but exclaim for many destructions. Say: "Is that (torment) better, or the Paradise of Eternity promised for those who have Taqwa?" It will be theirs as a reward and as a final destination>[25:11-15] Similarly He said; iThe description of the Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised^ meaning its description and qualities; iJ&Vf ^Underneath it riversflow> these rivers flow in the various parts and grades of Paradise and wherever its people wish they flow and gush forth for them. Allah also said, MS /X 'J& £\$ £ 'JfjMMX fe M\$ 0) 4 (MS vLM¥ otQ, MM ctifh\$ fk -f iThe description of Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised (is that) in it are rivers of water the taste and smell ofwhich are not changed, rivers ofwine delicious to those who drink, and rivers of clarified honey, therein for them is every kind offruit, andforgiveness.> [47:15] Allah said next, iits provision is eternal and so is its shade

call of nature, but Paradise is pure [from feces and urine]?' The Prophet sg said, ,/tA '1 * ~ 'I if o Ixij j 1 'One o/ them (residents of Paradise) relieves the call of nature through a sweat that emanates from the skin, with the scent of musk, and the stomach becomes empty again. Imam Ahmad and An-Nasal collected this HadithJ Allah said in other Ayat, 4i&f iAnd fruit in plenty, whose supply is not cut off nor are they out of reach.>[56:32-33], and, iAnd the shade thereof is close upon them, and the bunches of fruit thereofwill hang low urithin their reach.}[76:14] The shade of Paradise is everlasting and never shrinks, just as Allah said, Q% Ug-S® y* utffr swjfeega v.A iBut those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow, abiding therein forever. Therein they shall have pure mates, and We shall admit them to shades wide and ever deepening. \$[4:57] Allah often mentions the description of Paradise and the description of the Fire together, to make Paradise appealing and warn against the Fire. This is why, after Allah mentioned

the description of Paradise here. He next said,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2833–2846]

ithis is the end (final destination) of those who have Taqwa, and the end (final destination) of the disbelievers is Fire.} Allah said in another Ayah , Ahmad 4:367 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 1178.

^ j 1 2_4j ^Say; "Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe."} [17:107], until, CJ 2? iTruly, the promise ofour Lord must be fulfilled.} [17:109] meaning, Allah's promise to us in our Books to send Muhammad jg is true. It is certain and will surely come to pass and be fulfilled, so all praise to our Lord, how truthful is His promise, all the thanks are due to Him, i&fr 4And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.} [17: 109] Allah said next, %-A J* 'off} ibut there are among the Ahzdb (Confederates) those who reject a part thereof.} meaning, There are those among the sects who disbelieve in some of what was revealed to you (O Muhammad).' Mujahid said that, ibut there are among the Ahzdb (Confederates)}, refers to Jews and Christians, ithose who reject a part thereof}, meaning, They reject a part of the truth that came down to you - O Muhammad.' Similar was reported from Qatadah and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. ' Allah said in similarAyat, tyiii oJ he

And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, At-Tabari 16:474. Meaning Allah has not done those things mentioned in Ayahno 3 1

Sarah 13. Ar-Ra'd (38-39) (Part-13) 297 tJ e&m xot ,W 6* ^ u!\Js , ^1,4^i \3jUupjfc eiy*>1 -.-j\gdJ liiWij ©jGJi^.'iSsJW-***- " •-• *> 4f/ien you will not have any Wall (protector) or defender against Allah.} This part of the Ayah warns people of knowledge against following the paths of misguidance after they had gained knowledge in (and abided by) the Prophetic Sunnah and the path of Muhammad, may Allah's best peace and blessings be on him. 43 « 4Z &\$ ^S> tf lij 2£ £# p £££ 4mT 4 ij jl t£Z \$*,<& fi p rCuftj 4rIJ "WS. C <&! 4 >-•'«*-==»)' 438. And indeed We sent Messengers before you, and made for them wives and offspring. And it was not for a Messenger to bring a sign except by Allah's leave. (For) every matter there is a decree (from Allah).} 439. Allah blots out what He wills and confirms (what He wills). And with Him is the Mother of the Book.} All Prophets and Messengers were Humans Allah says, 'Just as We have sent you O Muhammad, a Prophet and a human, We sent the Messengers before you from among mankind, that eat food, walk in the markets, and We gave them wives and offspring.' Allah said to the most honorable and Final Messenger,

Meaning of Allah blotting out what He wills and confirming what He wills of the Book Allah said, C& i£Z} iAllah blots out what He wills} of the divinely revealed Books, iand confirms}, until the Qur'an, revealed from Allah to His Messenger peace be upon him, abrogated them all. Mujahid commented; lit \J^} iAllah blots out what He wills and confirms (what He wills).} "Except life and death, misery and happiness [i.e., faith and disbelief], for they do not change." ' MansUr said that asked Mujahid, "Some of us say in their supplication, 'O Allah! If my name is with those who are happy (believers), affirm my name among them, and if my name is among the miserable ones (disbelievers), remove it from among them and place it among the happy ones.'" Mujahid said. "This supplication is good." I met him a year or more later and repeated the same question to him and he recited these Aydt, iWe sent it (this Qur'an) down on a blessed night.} Mujahid commented next, "During Laylatul-Qadr (Night of the Decrees), Allah decides what provisions and disasters will occur in the next year of. He then brings forward or back (or blots out) whatever He wills. As for the Book containing the records of the happy (believers) and the miserable (disbelievers), it does not change."12' Al-A'mash narrated that Abu Wall, Shaqiq bin Salamah said that he used to recite this supplication often, "O Allah, if You wrote us among the wretched ones, remove this status from us and write us among the blessed ones. If You wrote us among the blessed ones, please let us stay that way, for surely, You blot out £md At-Tabari 16:479. 121 At-Tabari 16:480.

wills. And Allah is able to do all things.> [2:284] id L T ji^c. Liji jl Juo alley U vat^% ,L£j^ -5 i I^L- ^Vi\$ ci t£ 440. Whether We show you part of what We have promised them or cause you to die, your duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning.} 441 . See they not that We gradually reduce the land from its outlying borders. And Allah judges, there is none to put back His judgement, and He is swift at reckoning.} Punishment is by Allah, and the Messenger's Job is only to convey the Message Allah said to His Messenger j£, 4^%/ '4Whether We show you O Muhammad, part of the disgrace and humiliation We have promised your enemies in this life, 4MZ 4or cause you to die} before that, 4ki« <i£0,6} 4your duty is only to convey} We have only sent you to convey to them Allah's Message, and by doing so, you will have fulfilled the mission that was ordained on you, i&j} 4and on

Us is the reckoning}, their reckoning and recompense is on Us.' Allah said in similar Ayat, im* Oj Jr ^4l v'iJi 4So remind them - you are only one who reminds . You are not a dictator over than - Save the one who turns away and Al-Qurtubi 9 :33 1

disbelieves. Then Allah will punish him with the greatest punishment. Verily, to Us will be their return. Then verily, far Us will be their reckoning.}[88:21-26] Allah said next. iSee they not that We gradually reduce the land from its outlying borders. Ibn 'Abbas commented, "See they not thatWe are granting land after land to Muhammad (^J?" Al-Hasan and Ad-Dahhak commented that this Ayah refers to Muslims gaining the upper hand over idolaters,121 just as Allah said in another Ayah, £ j3> c gffl iAnd indeed We have destroyed towns round about you.} [46:27] fa. j&3f fafaj^y c iu ifaf. yfai ^ Zj} 442. And verily, those before them did devise plots, but all planning is Allah's. He knows what every person earns, and the disbelievers will know who gets the good end (final destination).} The Disbelievers plot, but the Believers gain the Good End Allah says, 4And verily, those before them did devise plots,} against their Messengers, they wanted to expel them from their land, but Allah devised plots against the disbelievers and gave the good end to those who fear Him. Allah said in other Ayat,)&& \& 'S4 HJ} At-Tabari 16:493. (2) Al-Tabari 16:494.

4And (remember) when the disbelievers plotted against you tc imprison you, or to kill you, or to get you out; they wen plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the Best of those who plot.} [8:30], and, ilil* ==> V ffi l4= 4So they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation, all together.^[27:50,51] Allah said next, 4He knows what every person earns,} meaning, He alone knows all secrets and concealed thoughts and will reckon each person according to his work, OP fe') and the Kafir (disbeliever) will know ijP} or the Kuffar (disbelievers) according to another way] reciting, <j&&&&¥ of iwho gets the good end.} who will earn the ultimate and final victory, they or the followers of the Messengers. Indeed, the followers of the Messengers will earn the good end in this life and the Hereafter, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. •Xfr Cr"J cjri0 P=> J* 'K-~Vr' '—*-1 \iP 1' 443. And those who disbelieved, say: "You are not a Messenger." Say: "Sufficient as a witness between me and you is Allah and those too who have knowledge of the Scripture."}

X , 4And My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those ivho have Taqwd, and give Zakah; and those who believe in Our Ayat; Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom theyfind written with thetn in the Tawrdh and the Injil [7:156-157] and, *ip j* \$&m ilt is not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children of Israel knew it (as true)? \$[26:\97) There are similar Ayat that affirm that the scholars of the Children of Israel know this fact from their divinely revealid Books. This is the end of Surat Ar-Ra'd, and all praise is due to Allah and all favors are from Him.

306 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr The TafslrofSurah Ibrahim (Chapter -14) Whichwas revealed inMakkah P *— In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Jl « JM -krf j-+?j ujU # 4;^' Jfp' ofjV' 4 llj oy —1J') U j; SrOJ /' /'.*A / jp qii /' >*" 1 ^ •*' f <>// il. Alif-Ldm-Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light by their Lord's leave to the path of the Almighty, the Praised.} 42. Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth! And woe unto the disbelieversfrom a severe torment.} ijAj^ Yj

Surah 14: Ibrahim

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Opening

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Opening 43. Those who prefer the life of this world to the Hereafter, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah and seek crookedness therein - they are far astray.} Describing the Qur'an and warning Those Who defy it Previously we discussed the meaning of the separate letters that appear in the beginnings of some Surahs. 4 (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you. Allah says, This is a Book that We have revealed to you, Muhammad. This 'Book', is the Glorious Qur'an, the most honored Book, that Allah sent down from heaven to the most honored Messenger of Allah sent to all the people of the earth, Arabs and non-Arabs alike, in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light} We sent you, O Muhammad, with this Book in order that you might lead mankind away from misguidance and crookedness to guidance and the right way, 'Jit S{ \ \$x 4\$ tij jl Jit ot fvsrjTH 4 Allah is the Wall (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darkness into light. But as for those who disbelieve, their Awliya (supporters and helpers) are Taghut (false deities), they bring them out from light into darkness.} [2:257], and, 4-S^' St tfj' f*} ilt is He Who sends down manifest Ayat to His servant that He may bring you out from darkness into light.} [57:9] Allah said next, iby their Lord's leave}. He guides those whom He destined to be guided by the hand of His Messenger jg, whom He

on account of those who defy or betray it. When the disbelievers do this, they become engulfed in ignorance and misguidance far away from truth, and therefore, there is no hope that they will gain guidance and correctness while on this state. jij i4. And We sent not a Messenger except with the language of his people, in order that he might make (the Message) clear for them. Then Allah misleads whom He wills and guides whom He wills. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise Every Prophet was sent with the Language of His People; Guidance or Misguidance follows the Explanation Allah is Kind and Compassionate with His creation, sendir g Messengers to them from among them and speaking then- language, so that they are able to understand the Message that the Messengers were sent with. Allah said next, 4*^4 iy *tlj j* <i' i Then Allah misleads whom He wills and guides whom He wills. after the proof and evidence have been established for the people, Allah misguides whom He wills from the path of guidance and guides whom He wills to the truth, 4 And He is the All-Mighty,} whatever He wills occurs and whatever He does not will never occurs, 4 the All-Wise.£ in His decisions, misleading those who deserve to be misled and guiding those who deserve guidance. This is from Allah's wisdom with His creation, every Prophet He sent to a people spoke their language and everyone of these Prophets were only sent to their people. Muhammad bin 'Abdullah, Allah's Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, was sent to all people. It is recorded in the Two SahOis that Jabir said that the Messenger of Allah said,

ij .bt ji ^ iBring out your people from darkness into light,} call them to all that is good and righteous, in order that they might turn away from the darkness of ignorance and misguidance they indulged in, to the light of guidance and the enlightenment of faith, iand remind them of the annals (or days) of Allah} remind them (O MQsa) of Allah's days, meaning, favors and bounties which He bestowed on them when He delivered them from the grip of Fir'awn and his injustice, tyranny and brutality. This is when Allah delivered them from their enemy, made a passage for them through the sea, shaded them with clouds, sent down manna and quails for them, and other favors and bounties. Mujahid, Qatadah and several others said thisJV Allah said next, iTruly, therein are Ayatfor every patient, thankful (person).} Allah says, 'Our delivering ofOur loyal supporters among thie Children of Israel from the grasp of Fir'awn and saving therh from the disgraceful torment, provides a lesson to draw from for those who are patient in the face of affliction, and thankful in times of prosperity. Qatadah said, "Excellent is the servant who if he is tested, he observes patience, and if he is granted prosperity, he is thankful for it."*21 It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jg said, out 43 b\s V ii <i>t 'j \ ->i» t\j^out Iv, "Verily, all of the matter of the believer is amazing, for every decision that Allah decrees for him is good for him. If an affliction strikes him, he is patient and this is good for him; if a bounty is give to him, he is thankfid and this is At-Tabari 16:521. AMabari 16:523.

312 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr ^ mm ™ ^ ,> -i" *. t •*>- :? 'Ci ^ > c.c *. jvJbsSllle-4tt\Aa_m>£^==»jl^J_yjp" _y* ** JP> S0Z-jfSpj\$%^64[<& J ^ jl1^==^*> 0+tfJh0X%c&&&Z good for him. \lr*~g>J A-ijiJ i<_y* J'i ij_>^ jl pfesUlc *i' A«JU /<> .< > >" / "'•• I.' •• •j** >-u>>^»-* <4* ^ j> .' / /T^- / p==U> Jj f=>*W U^r^vwIJ ifjJJ* ,^3 04 ' > ^>=6 o0 f|3j^ ip i>J < 0*^=* ?£Mj\$ 0^ &y liy^~ioCJ i^Jjc tlf^ 4£ jtf £& 4.0 f - l ". ,i sf{.,*,*~*~^ *n' 46. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "Call to mind Allah's favor to you, when He delivered you \from Fir'awn's people who were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were slaughtering your sons and letting your women live; and in it was a tremendous trialfrom your Lord."} 47. And (remember) when your Lord proclaimed: "If you give tlwnks, I will give you more; but if you are thankless, verily. My punishment is indeed severe."} 48. And Musa said: "If you disbelieve, you and all on earth togetlw, then verily, Allah is Rich (free of all needs), Worthy of all praise."} Allah states that Musa reminded his people about Allah's annals and days and of Allah's favors and bounties that He bestowed on them, when He saved them from Fir'awn and his 111 MusUm 4:2295.

people and the torment and disgrace they used to exert on them. They used to slaughter whomever they could find among their sons and let their females live. Allah delivered them from all this torment, and this is a great bounty, indeed. This is why Allah described this affliction, Jt iatid in it was a tremendous trialfrom your Lord.) Tor He granted you (O Children of Israel) a great favor Ifor which you are unable to perfectly thank Him.' Some scholars said that this part of the Ayah means, "what Fir'awn used to do to you was a tremendous 4trial.)' Both meanings might be considered here and Allah knows best. Allah said in another Ayah , iAnd We tried them with good and evil in order that they might him (to Allah).) (7:168) Allah's statement next, 4And (remember) when your Lord proclaimed) means, proclaimed and made known His promise to you. It is possible that this Ayah means, your Lord has vowed and sworn by His might, grace and exaltness. Allah said in a similar Ayah, 4i^ij)' | OwJ illy iAnd (remember) when your Lord declared that He would certainly keep on sending against them (i.e. the Jews), till the Day of

Resurrection .) (7:167) Allah said,)If you give thanks, I will give you more;) meaning, 'if you appreciate My favor on you, I will give you more of it, vAj)

«O My servants. If the first and the last among you, mankind and Jinns among you, had the heart of the most pious and righteous man among you, that will not increase my kingdom in the least. O My servants! If the first and the last among you, mankind and the Jinns among you, had the heart of the most wicked man among you, that will not decrease My kingdom in the least. O My servants! If the first and the last among you, the mankind and Jinns among you, stood in one flat area and each asked me (what they wish), and I gave each one of them what they asked, that will not decrease My kingdom except by that which the needle carries (of water) when inserted in the ocean .">111 Verily, all praise and glory are due to Allah, the Rich [free of need], the Worthy of all praise. * U \$5 px iR»| kijfX .ij 49. Has not the news reached you, of those before you, the people of NQh, "Ad, and Thamud? And those after them? None knows them but Allah. To them came their Messengers with clear proofs, but they put their hands in their mouths and said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent, and we are really in grave doubt as to that to which you invite us."4 Earlier Nations disbelieved in Their Prophets Allah narrated to this Ummah (followers of Muhammad the stories of the people of Prophet Nuh, 'Ad and Thamud, and other ancient nations that belied their Messengers. Only Allah knows the count of these nations, 4To them came their Messengers with clear proofs, they brought them evidences and plain, tremendous proofs and signs. Ibn Ishaq reported that 'Amr bin Maymun said that 111 Muslim 4:1994.

'Abdullah said about Allah's statement, i'M\$££ 'j) iNone knows them but Allah.) "The genealogists utter lies." * This is why Urwah bin Az- Zubayr said, "We did not find anyone who knows the forefathers of Ma'dd bin 'Adman."12 Meaning of, **They put Their Hands in Their Mouths?' Allah said next, tj ibut they put their hands in their mouths) It is said that they pointed to the Messengers' mouths asking them to stop calling them to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. It is also said that it means, they placed their hands on their mouths in denial of the Messengers. It was also said that it means that they did not answer the call of the Messengers, or they were biting their hands in rage. Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka*b and Qatadah said that they belied the Messengers and refuted their call with their mouths.13* I (Ibn Kathir) say that Mujahid's Tafsir is supported by the completion of the narrative. 4 tr# \go iand said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent, and we are really in grave doubt as to that to which you invite us.") Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When they heard Allah's Word, they were amazed and placed their hands on their mouths, 14' u jl,}%& ti iand said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent.") 111 At-Tabari 16:528. * Tafsir Al-Qurtubi 9 :344 131 AMabari 16:534. |4* At-Tabari 16:533.

to v ^>.v\\ "w \$^j4i: \$yu^o- \$i£4&^ ©i=4f 3iici^;^i They said, We do not believe what you brought us, and have strong doubt in its authenticity.' -if 41 ;#£ -ite \$ &K 4&& & 0* j-£{ f£*£ -si5} ^ ^1 £3 ii 9c3^ i< £ >£ .1 * l \it»U^- ujJUa> o' OJJj> L£- i#U \$&: iii' ^ a©^ #i *JZ. % £ 61. O' d* <»»> |»^=4 u ^<X i;j .«i^e o- 'ill S 6%ic^i (Xsts ll -111 Je "jl LJ ly 405^ -if J5 te>; t£ 6^2; t^Gui J& 410. TTier Messengers said: "(What!) Can there be a doubt about Allah, the Creator of the heavens and the earth? He calls you that He may forgive you of your sins and give you respite for a term appointed." They said: "You are no more than human beings like us! You wish to turn us away from what our fathers used

to worship. Then bring us a clear authority."} 411. Their Messengers said to them: "We are no more than human beings like you, but Allah bestows His grace to whom He wills of His servants. It is not ours to bring you an authority (proof) except by the permission of Allah. And in Allah (alone) let the believers put their trust."} 422. "And why should we not put our trust in Allah while He

319 Surah 14. Ibrahim (10-12) (Part-13) Disbelievers reject Prophethood because the Messengers were Humans! Their nations said, 4&%%z 4You are no more than human beings like us!} so why should we follow you just because you say so, even! though we did not witness a miracle by your hands, &JL} 4Then bring us a clear authority. 4, a miracle of our choice. 4'tl oj iTheir Messengers said to them "We are no more than human beings like you ..."4 affirming that truly, they were only human being like their nations, 4but Allah bestows His grace to whom He wills of His servants.4, with prophethood and messengership which is His choice, J u vLK vf} is not ours to bring you an authority} according to your choice, 4except by the permission of Allah.}, after we beg Him and He provides us with a miracle, 4L£ £i\\$ &&} 4And in Allah (alone) let the believers put their trust.} in all their affairs. Their Messengers said to them next, 43SS U V,} 4And why should we not put our trust in Allah}, after He had guided us to the best, most clear and plain way, Xi ii/yUl} 4And we shall certainly bear with patience all the hurt you may cause

321 Surah 14. Ibrahim (13-17) (Part-13) The people of Prophet Lut, peace be upon him, said, 4 02 J' iDrive out the family of Lut from your city.} [27:56] Allah said about the idolators of Quraysh, "^1 'Ail- - CjSjr-k y bjj {jL JjJrfij Jfjii Lrt IAK==* j!_j^ iAnd verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to I drive you out from the land. But in that case they would not have stayed after you, except for a little while.}[17:76] and, -4*- <5>b <*' 'fiiJ OjJSwj A \$ A^ju jl JjLjj i^iST crA\ A, 'fAA Aff} i!\$. iAnd when the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you out; they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the Best of those who plot.} [8:30] Allah gave victory and aid to His Messenger jg after he emigrated from Makkah and gathered followers, supporters, and soldiers around him, who fought in the cause of Allah, the Exalted. Allah kept granting His Messenger jg more dominance until He opened for him Makkah, which sought to expel him. Allah gave him dominance over it, even when his enemies from Makkah and the rest of the people of the earth disliked it. Soon after, people began embracing the religion of Allah in large crowds and in a very short time Allah's Word and religion became high over all other religions, from the eastern and! western parts of the world. Hence Allah's statement, *1 iSo their Lord revealed to them : "Truly, We shall destroy the wrongdoers. And indeed. We shall make you dwell in the land after them."} [14:13,14] Allah said in other Aydt, '£ GjT iAnd, verily. Our Word has gone forth of old for Our

WgJ fli* Oli. C/4 I iThen for him who transgressed all bounds, and preferred the life of this world, verily, his abode will be Hellfire. But as for him who feared standing before his Lord, and restrained himself from impure evil desires and lusts. Verily, Paradise will be his abode.}[79:37-41] and, SC iBut for him who fears the standing before his Lord, there will be two Gardens.^[55:46] Allah said next, iAnd they sought victory and help} refers to the Messengers who sought the help and victory of their Lord over their nations, according to 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah.m 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah refers to the nations, invoking Allah's victory against themselves!*2 Some idolaters said, Allah ! If this (Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then

rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment.} [8:32) It is possible that both meanings are desired here, for the idolaters (of Quraysh) invoked Allah against themselves on the day of Badr, and the Messenger of Allah invoked Him for victory and support Allah said to the idolaters then, 4(0 disbelievers) if you ask for a judgment, now has the judgment come unto you; and if you cease (to do wrong), it At-Tabari 16:544-545. At-Tabari 16:545.

111 At-Tirmidhi nos. 2573,2574.

O* J-f ^77iis is so/ Then let than taste it - Hamim and Ghassaq. And other (torments) of similar kind all together!}{38:57-58\ Mujahid and Ikrimah said that this festering water is made of puss and blood. 11 ' Allah said in other Ayat, 4And be given to drink boiling water so that it cuts up their bowels.} (47:15) and, & Jy& IASSM iAnd if they ask for help, they will be granted water like boiling oil, that will scald their faces.} [18:29] Allah's statement, iHe will sip it unwillingly}, indicates that he will hate to drink this water, but he will be forced to sip it; he will refuse until the angel strikes him with an iron bar, idw « fob iAnd for them are hooked rods of iron.}[22:21] Allah said next, Ms-i %b iand he will find great difficulty in swallowing it down his throat,} meaning, he will hate to swallow it because of its awful taste, color and unbearable heat or coldness, i^S oj £J2(JCj} iand death will come to him from every side,} his organs, limbs and entire body will suffer pain because of this drink. 'Amr bin Maymun bin Mahran commented, "Every Al-Tabari 16:548.

326 Tafstr Ibn Kathir bone, nerve and blood vessel." Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, Jt iand death will come to him from every side,} "All types of torment that Allah will punish him with on the Day of Resurrection in the fire of Jahannam will come to him carrying death, if he were to die. However, he will not die because Allah the Exalted said, JU* Vj ifiOj y} iNeither will it affect them that they die nor shall its torment be lightened for them^ISSiSe]."121 Therefore, according to Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him and his father, every type of punishment will come to him (the obstinate, rebellious tyrant) carrying death with it, if he will ever die there. Yet, he will not die, he will instead receive eternal punishment and torment. Hence Allah's statement here, iand death will come to him from every side, yet he will not die,} Allah said, iand in front of him, will be a great torment.} even in this condition, he will still suffer another severe type of torment, more severe and painful from the one before it, harsher more bitter. Allah described the tree of Zaqqum, oJ0 |*rlf m-j '\$• U (v+Py* f Oj f \$|p4>Ja3f 1? We# Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5:16. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :16

327 Surah 14. Ibrahim (13-17) (Part-13) iVerily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hellfire, the shoots of its fruits stalks are like the heads of Shayatin; Truly, they will eat thereof and fill their bellies therewith. Then on top of that they will be given boiling water to drink so that it becomes a mixture. Then thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell.}[37:64-68] Allah states that they will either be eating from the Zaqqum, drinking the Hamim, or being tormented in the Fire, again and again; we seek refuge with Allah from all of this. Allah also said, iThis is the Hell which the criminals denied. They will go between it (Hell) and the fierce boiling water/(55:43-44], iVerily, the tree of Zaqqum will be the food of the sinners. Like boiling oil, it will boil in the bellies, like the boiling of scalding water. (It will be said) "Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire, then pour over his head the torment of boiling water. Taste you (this)! Verily, you were the mighty, the generous!

Verily, this is that whereof you used to do»f>f/'>[44:43-50]. 4And those on the Left Hand - how (unfortunate) will be those on the Left Hand? In fierce hot wind and boiling water, and shadow of black smoke, neither cool nor pleasant.^[56:41-44], and. <*ii“ *jO-*3* jLfii jSj £jl!» ^ iThis is so! And for the Taghiin will be an evil final return. Hell! Where they will bum, and worst is that place to rest!

This is so! Then let them taste it Hamim and Ghassaq. And other (torments) of similar kind all fogef/ier/ ^[38:55-58] There are many other similar Ayat that indicate that the punishment they will receive is of different kinds, and that it is repeated in various types and forms that only Allah the Exalted knows, as just recompense, iAnd your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) slaves. [41:46] Sdjaj V fy. 4 ii •' 1££ ^} 438. 77ie parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously on a stormy day; they shall not be able to get aught of what they have earned. That is the straying, far away (from the right path).} A Parable for the Deeds of the Disbelievers This is a parable that Allah has given for the deeds and actions of the disbelievers who worshipped others besides Him and rejected His Messengers, thus building their acts on groundless basis. Their actions vanished from them when they were most in need of their rewards. Allah said, ^ & iThe parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works} on the Day of Judgment, when they will seek their rewards from Allah the Exalted. They used to think that they had something, but they will find nothing, except what remains of ashes when a strong wind blows on it, fy ^} ion a stormy day;} They will not earn rewards for any of the good works they performed during this life, except what they can preserve of ashes during a day of strong wind. Allah said in other Ayat,

^ ' 'T • irt ^ dll 4And We shall him to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.\$[25:23], e/j- cjd\ y* l^i gy jil£=* liJ!? ^ o>Uj C @&&\$ 'tub 111 iThe parable of what they spend in this world is that of a wind which is extremely cold; it struck the harvest of a people who did wrong against themselves and destroyed it. Allah wronged them not, but they wronged themselves .\$. [3:1 17], and, % h% &4 <sM tfiVb &Z, * !£fc UM Ck¥ 3t'j tS gz h -j*. V% \ ££=> lii fr6*4 40 you who believe! Do not render in vain your Sadaqah I (charity) by reminders of your generosity or by injury, like him who spends his wealth to be seen of men, and he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day. His parable is that of a 'N smooth rock on which is a little dust; on it falls heavy rain which leaves it bare. They are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people.\$[2:264] I Allah said in this Ayah, iLS&&> djy>\$ iThat is the straying, far away from the right path\$ meaning, their work and deeds were not based on firm, correct grounds, and thus, they lost their rewards when they needed them the most, 4L\$ jiilt£ iThat is the straying, far away from the right path.\$ ^ «&• vIj j&iA& oi 4-S^ 11 & dJ j 419. Do you not see that Allah has created the heavens and the

earth with truth? If He wills, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation!} i20. And for Allah that is not hard or difficult. Proof that Resurrection occurs after Death Allah affirms His ability to resurrect the bodies on the Day of Resurrection, stating that He has created the heavens and earth which are stronger than the creation of man. Is not He Who is able to create the heavens, high, wide and strongly built, which include in them the planets and stars and the various heavenly objects and clear signs. Is not He Who created this earth with all what it contains of land, valleys, mountains, deserts, green fields, barren lands, seas and various shapes, benefits, species and colors of trees, plants and

animals? Sf-- & if- of* 3*^ dk pj cfjtt «a1 ii fijty 4Do they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely, is able to do all things. 46:33], *£ 42G oi i3 ££if j iafi Ski (A) jG Tij» tJC jit ^ £ J42* \$k J £^ jE. 4 J# #4 && J o. ;j4 Tii tii 4Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah (drop of sperm). Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All- Knower of every creation!" He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, when behold you kindle therewith. Is not He

331 Surah 14. Ibrahim (19-20) (Part-13 Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is! So glorified is He and exalted above all that they associate with Him, and in Whose Hands is the dominion of all things: and to Him you shall be returned.}[36:77-83] Allah's statement. if He wills, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation! And for Allah that is not hard or difficult.} means, it is not hard or impossible for Allah to do that. Rather, it is easy for Him, that if you defy His order, He takes you away and brings in your place another creation who is unlike you. Allah said in other Ayat, peg. te 4 % Jt Ji SLffi% y>' Jp to ;,g,' JjJ-r Cf 40 mankind! It is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is Rich, Worthy of all praise. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation. And that is not hard for Allah.}[35:15-17], «J3£l -3 2 ^0 4And if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} [47:38] rr£ 4j-* -Oti 0* &J. if [A 1* \$£] 40 you who believe! Whoever from among you turns back from his religion, Allah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him.^[5:54] and, iff He wills, He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever All-Potent over that.}[4:133]

Y«A imm V, y}\ ^ sm. \jc. JihUj^ otJ^ibj! ^UZ;^kzz£JA Oo-^citQc^b^i -it \$jaift ^ oAsI4AJ.I ijlfic^ll JUi jjl !>^y^ £3 ii4=. q i2£L;(<\$1, * 1:' -r > ri >1 :'' s'' Cj't Ojr'+** j~*' tM-* v*J 3 jjJfe £\$• iK jA ~y>'j '5: 'pi'A %\ &Z U U ^Jy*> p i^2j3 1- j Crt 422. And f/iey all shall appear before Allah; then the weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Verily, we were following you; can you avail us anything against Allah's torment?" They will say: "Had Allah guided us, we would have guided you. It makes no difference to us (tiow) whether we rage, or bear (theseo ' torments) with patience; there is no place of refuge for us."} Disbelieving Chiefs and Their Followers will dispute in the Fire Allah said, iAnd they shall appear} meaning, all the creatures, the wicked and the righteous among them, will appear before Allah the One, the Irresistible. They will be gathered on a flat plain that does not have anything those present could use for cover, it then the weak will say} the followers who used to obey their chiefs, leaders and notables will say,

4!Z&J 4to those who were arrogant^ who rebelled against worshipping Allah alone without partners and obeying the Messengers, p &=, £[] 4 Verily, we were following you,}, we obeyed your orders and implemented them, / t X J* // * 'x X* > > { •x'^ \ * <jj s* 1 J+»r you avail us anything against Allah's torment?} They will ask, 'can you prevent any of Allah's torment from striking us as you used to promise and vow to us?' The leaders will say in response, 4p=£j& \$} '4Had Allah guided us, we would have guided you.} \ but the statement of our Lord shall come to pass concerning us, and the destiny that

He has appointed for us and you shall come true; the word of punishment shall befall the disbelievers, U l x 41t makes no difference to us (now) whether we rage, or bear (these torments) with patience; there is no place of refuge for I us.} I (Ibn Kathir) say that it appears that this conversation will occur in the Fire after they enter it, just as Allah said in otheij Ayat, JJij# j SpZ.10 jllli dA Llwu & 4M^^ 4And, when they will dispute in the Fire, the weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Verily, we followed you, can you then take from us some portion of the Fire?" Those who were arrogant will say: "We are all (together) in this (Fire)! Verily,

335Surah 14. Ibrahim (22-23) (Part-13) /wue been believers!" And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were wrongdoers Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day : when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?^[34:31-33] S?£ 'J, U fa) B * 4 ££ J 'Vj ^ 4 fX-" ^ , ,if <. >-"4 r> > •T'S r, V • •> jwlliaJ' Jr* Uj 0^4^-=a ^ >2*! Uj Ifi j* dJ/ (t4* 'ri 422 . And Shaytan will say when the matter has been decided "Verily, Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. So blame me i not, but blame yourselves. I cannot help you, nor can you help me. I deny your former act in associating me (Shaytan) as a partner with Allah (by obeying me in the life of the world). Verily, there is a painful tormentfor the wrongdoers I 423. And those who believed and did righteous deeds, will be made to enter Cardens under which rivers flow, - to dwell therein for ever (i.e. in Paradise), with the permission of their Lord. Their greeting therein will be: "Salam (peace!). Shaytan disowns His Followers on the Day of) Resurrection Allah narrates to us what Iblis will say to his followers after i Allah finishes with the judgement between His servants, sending the believers to the gardens of Paradise and the disbelievers to the lows (of the Fire). Iblis, may Allah curse him, will stand and address the latter, in order to add depression to their depression, sorrow to their sorrow and grief to their grief. He will declare,

4jfLl jij iul ^jf} "iVerily, Allah promised you a promise of truth.} by the words of His Messengers that if you follow them, you will gain safety and deliverance. Truly, Allah's promise was true and correct news, while I promised you then betrayed you.' Allah said in another Ayah, iHe (Shaytan) makes promises to than, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} (4:120) £ Jt 3 of C,} 41 had no authority over you} Shaytan will say, T had no proof for what I called you to, nor evidence for what I promised you, iexcept that I called you, and you responded to me.} even though the Messengers establish the proof and unequivocal evidences against you and affirmed the truth of what they were sent to you with. But you disobeyed the Messengers and ended up earning this fate, iSo blame me not,} today, ibut blame yourselves.}, because it is your fault for defying the proofs and following me in the falsehood that I called you to.' Shaytan will say next, cannot help you}, I cannot benefit, save, or deliver you from what you are suffering, %} 4nor can you help me.}, nor can you save me and deliver me

from the torment and punishment I am suffering, 41 deny your former act of associating me (Shaytan) as a partner with Allah. or because you associated me with Allah before,' according to Qatadah. * Ibn Jarir commented; "I deny being a partner with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored."*21 This opinion is the most plausible, for Allah said in other Ayat, jt 'fkj jy J] vi v OJJ CK 4 ^ fL \j£ J-!3 _j~>- 4And who is more astray than one who calls on others besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, I and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.^[46:5-6] and, 4Nay, but they (the so-called gods) will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.}[19:82] Allah said next, ol> 4Verily, the wrongdoers who deviate from truth and follow falsehood, will earn a painful torment. It appears that this part of the Ayah narrates the speech that Shaytan will deliver to the people of the Fire after they enter it, as we stated. 'Amir Ash- Sha*bi said, "On the Day of Resurrection, two speakers will address the people. Allah the Exalted will say to 'Isa, son of Maryam, 4^* 0_-3 jjGJJ tS.it 4Did you say unto men : "Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?"} [5:116] until, 111 At-Tabari 16:564. At-Tabari 16:561.

g£& 'if ti} 4Allah will say: "This is a Day on which the truthful will profit from their truth."}[5:1 19] Shaytan, may Allah curse him, will stand and address the people, 41 had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. ll] Allah next mentioned the final destination of the miserable ones, who earned the disgrace and torment and having to listen to Shaytdn address them, then He mentioned the final destination of the happy ones, iZfrf &*^ tjUj \p: pfo 4And those who believed and did righteous deeds, will be made to enter Gardens under which rivers flow,} wherever they wish them to flow and wherever they may be, 4^ 4to dwell therein for ever,} and will never transfer or be transferred from it, 4with the permission of their Lord. Their greeting therein will be: "Salam (peace!).)"AMh said in other Aydt, 4£=& tij ^4; \ij%. iii p} 4Till, when they reach it, and its gates will be opened and its keepers will say: "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you!)" (39:73) 4&p yCf j:£ Sjlil '&\$\$,} 4And angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you!).)" [13:23-24] At-Tabari 16:562,

{Therein they shall be met with greetings and the word of peace and respect.} [25:75] k^ 4 pL ^ pg; jtff {Their way of request therein will be Subhanaka Allahumma (glory to you, O Allah) and Salam (peace!) will be their greetings therein (Paradise)! And the close of their request will be: Al-Hamdu Lilldhi Rabbil-'Alamin [all praise to Allah the Lord of that ejrisfsJ.>[10:10], ujLUJ JIMfi ii' uiL JT 1 1 1^ -i1 ay . \" . »lh -*? / f {24. See you not how Allah sets forth a parable? A goodly word as a goodly tree, whose root is firmly fixed, and its branches (reach) to the sky.} {25. Giving its fruit at all times, by the leave of its Lord, and Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember.} {26. And the parable of an evil word is that of an evil tree uprooted from the surface of earth, having no stability.} The Parable of the Word of Islam and the Word of Kufr 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas commented that Allah's statement, {tA'i^te} {a parable: a goodly word}, refers to testifying to La ildha illaUah, (none has the right to be worshipped but Allah) while, {i4>ZZ&} {as a goodly tree}, refers to the believer, and that,

iwhose root is firmly fixed>, indicates that La ilaha illalldh, (none has the right to be worshipped but Allah) is firm in the believers' heart, i&zit iand its branches (reach) to the sky.\$ with which the

believer's works are ascended to heaven. Similar is said by Ad-Dahhak, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid and several others. 121 They stated that this parable describes the believer's deeds, good statements and good actions. The believer is just like the beneficial date tree, always having good actions ascending at all times, by day and by night. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "We were with the Messenger of Allah when he asked, 'Tell me about a tree that resembles the Muslim, the leaves of which do not fall in summer or winter and gives its fruit at all times by the leave of its Lord.' Ibn Umar said, "I thought of the date palm tree, but felt shy to answer when I saw that Abu Bakr and Umar did not talk. When they did not give an answer, the Messenger of Allah said, "It is the date palm tree." When we departed, I said to Umar, "My father, by Allah! I thought that it was the date tree." He said, "Why did you not speak then?" I said, "I saw you were silent and I felt shy to say anything." Umar said, "Had you said it, it would have been more precious to me than such things (i.e., would have been very precious to me)."

13 At-Tabari 16:567. At-Tabari 16:572-573. FathAl-Bari 8:228.

341 Surah 14. Ibrahim (24-26) (Part-13 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said that, 'This is a goodly tree', is a tree in Paradise. Allah said next, 'Giving its fruit at all times, by day and by night. It is said that it means by day and by night. And they say that describes the believer as a tree that always has fruits during summer and winter, by night and by day. This is the parable of the believer whose good works ascend to heaven by day and by night and at all times, by the leave of its Lord, thus earning perfection and becoming beneficial, plentiful, pure and blessed, and Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember.' Allah said next, 'And the parable of an evil word is that of an evil tree describing the disbelief of the disbeliever, for it has no basis or stability. It is similar to the colocynth tree (a very bitter, unscented plant) which is also called, Ash-Shiryan. Shu'bah narrated that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Qurrah narrated that Anas bin Malik said that it is the colocynth tree. Allah said, 'Uprooted', meaning, was cut off from the root, and from the surface of earth, having no stability. therefore, existing without basis or stability, just like Kufr (disbelief), for it does not have a basis or roots. Surely, the At-Tabari 16:573. * At-Tabari 16:569.

342 Tafstr Ibn Kathir works of the disbelievers will never ascend nor will any of them be accepted. Allah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the wrongdoers to go astray, and Allah does what He wills. Allah keeps the Believers Firm in This Life and in the Hereafter with a Word that stands Firm Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara bin 'Azib, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said, 'When the Muslim is questioned in the grave, he will testify that, 'La ilaha illallah', and that Muhammad is Allah's Messenger, hence Allah's statement, 'Allah will keep firm those who believe, with word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter. Muslim and the rest of the Group recorded it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Bara bin 'Azib said, "We went with the Messenger of Allah to attend a funeral procession of an Ansari man. We reached the grave site when it had not yet been completed. The Messenger of Allah sat, and we sat all around him, as if there were birds hovering above our heads. The Prophet was holding a piece of wood in his hand, poking the ground with it. He next raised his head and said twice or thrice, 'Allah will keep firm those who believe, with word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter. Muslim 4 :2201, Abu Dawud 5:112, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :547, An-Nasab in As-Sunan Al-Kubra 6 :372

>Seek refuge with Allah from the punishment of the grave. He said next, && 4\ 's^ j* Jdij di)i j* j b\ s lit
 jiii b\ l)Us\ ja yS (>4" |»4*yrj& »HUL J xj*~ * <s>i ^ «4 '>44“ Lf ^ !»>»•J <&' Si J\ i^T^ ^r^J' :J>£» 'i--
 b jlp >J4« Ui>-f Ijji i LaJL>-ti i.UDIJ fJA ifaii\ J..-7 Ui' ij__ £^»Ji 7- JI» - ^ Jj ^ ui ui* <*4* 5t?i ui j4*
 * * <* _ ' j i jS/ 1 O-j Jp oi>j ».*!.*-; Mi i_D>(£ t^ .il»_ ^DI ?Bji £,*« 5ii u ill'll vi i&fclij St; J* ji: * i
 ix>~ J **j* ""I)>^ ^jjJl }Sllll {fr^i iji :j_)>3 Ujjji! jUi js^ 3 £13 '3 din .udi J| * i_4=L: Ij^» :^I .111)1 JI
 i* JI iiyS JI ,UDi JI 'r*4*f 443 4*^ 44 JI* JI 44^3 J ts# 4 l4 1)—4^*1* «j(3 (.AllJ O-Jj jlii : JI» l^S^sT-f
 ojli l£>3 Ji* :J>3 ?ilLa U :'*} jV>3 i&l J5 :J>3 ?i£ J jtfJ3 tji)l J i J_>1» <i-sj i^ill ll* i 7*1 <jV_jj£i
 i^VI^l ill* iOJJLpj 4j d»U jll 1-liS ot'j» ' l'j5* 9.M*la Lij ; Jj j'iyd d l_)>c»lj .^>JI i<1)1 jj4 o_j-iyti
 ^Jl-p jxl of 7.111)1 ^ ifr Jt ^ 4r4»3 4>-jj Iri 7- JU - dlJl JJ CU ^JJ Ij j^S Jyt~* i Ji I i—J» c^IJI jI>- tj>-
 ^Jl J^j *4'^ ^44-y J 7 ij Jyii <J&y v£lS ^jjJl Iji t4plDI |^l «—>j ipID I ^f !J i^llJl DUj lil ! (Jj^7»
 ^J>l j •Ju3^ J4- •lATien a believing slave is reaching the end of his term in the life of this world and the
 beginning of his term in the Hereafter, a group of angels, whose faces are white and as radiant as the
 sun, will descend onto him from heaven. They will carry with them white shroud from Paradise, and
 fragrance for

enshrining from Paradise. Titey will sit as far from him as the sight goes. Then, the angel of death, will
 come until he sits right next to his head, saying, "O, good and pure soul! Depart (your body) to Allah's
 forgiveness and pleasure." So the soul flows (out of its body), just as the drop flows out from the tip of
 the jug, and the angel of death captures it. When he captures the soul, they (the group of angels) will not
 leave it with him for more than an instance, and they will seize it and wrap it in that shroud, and in that
 fragrance. A most pleasant musk scent ever found on the earth, will flow out of the soul, and the angels
 will ascend it (to heaven). They will not pass by, but they will say, "Whose is this Tayyib (good) soul?"
 They (the angels who are ascending the soul) will reply, "Such person, the son of such and such
 person," - calling him by the best names that he used to be called in the world. They will reach the
 lower heaven and will ask that its door be opened for him, and it will be opened for them. The best
 residents of every heaven will then see him to the next heaven, until he is brought to the seventh
 heaven. Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, will say, "List my servants record in TIUyyin and send him
 back to earth, for I have created them from it, and into it I shall return than, and from it I shall bring
 than out once again." The soul will be joined with its body, and two angels will come to him, sit him up
 and ask him, "Who is your Lord?" He will say, "Allah is my Lord." They will ask him, "What is your
 religion?" He will say, "My religion is Islam." They will say to him, "What do you say about this man
 (Prophet Muhammad) who was sent to you?" He will say, "He is the Messenger of Allah." They will
 ask him, "And what proof do you have about it?" He will say, "I read the Book of Allah (the Qur'an),
 and had faith and belief in him." Then, a caller (Allah) will herald from heaven, "My servant has said
 the truth. Therefore, furnish him from Paradise, and let him wear from (the clothes of) Paradise, and
 open a door for him to Paradise." So he is given from Paradise's tranquillity and good scent, and his
 grave will be expanded for him as far as his sight can reach. Then, a man, with a handsome face and
 handsome See Surat Al-Mutafifin 83 :18-21

345 Surah 14. Ibrahim (27) (Part-13) clothes and whose scent is pleasant, will come to him, saying,
 "Receive the glad tidings with that which pleases you. This is the Day which you were promised." He
 will ask him, "Who are you; for yours is the face that carries the good news?" He will reply, "I am your
 good works." He will say, "O Lord! Hurry up with the commencement of the Hour, hurry up with the

commencement of the Hour, so I can return to my family and my wealth.” 4\ ji jtpP J otf ill j&i vil jp : Jli i jS <0-4 ipLo b^pjl s olUL3 l J»iw pj bit—iJl P-oJl Lpl : J_p» pUp opJi JiU -_ipi!! ja 3yiLi\ US Ifj-flJ oJuU- ijS ' ~ Jli - -oi-j 4)1 ja sill;^ UjJUXJ iip ?4d^ UP<X P UJU-i lili Ui>-Ui iJjAlUl iLjj jj.uio.l U-j Op-j ip- Eij pLS Ip :jffd ^j'J P U : ipii Nj iS5*Jip)u Ju p pp; j! P ir*- P p ^4-Lj jLS «JUS.i jpl u'iSi ji j"& 4*J*t jP 4ll bJ_pj p p — <J ^Ai <J ~ ~ ' « b UjJl .UDl j p=s ipsi :iii jfd ii<M p 4 jiif g &. sj&i si; .pi i2ks 4A. i_p PP ly p - U-p £>3 k(piJi p;Vi p jUw. P ilia 4^- yfc J * d^S jt jjC£ji .13? P S/ olo oL& !dpi ?»SLj ^4 ! <d jS/pjj <0 (— >t 1 jLSLL. ojtp i oj—>- i^Jl Jpp IJU U : <J jNpii 1 S? »U «U : Jpli U : iJ jSlpi tSff piS jt r.UUJ! p illa ^jjCi 'iSpt S? »U Sli :Jp» ' 1 U ^ja o-j(j tjlljl P) LL <J .j0l »j«ijiU lJ^4 lv_4Ul3l £*_» l4>-_pl ^_3 Jj>-J ojuj <oj <_4£>j op *lip ^4j !Jpj t -Uy Ow ji«^j lii b ^Jlj ! Jpj b^j^l S/ ! bJ_p3 bc^ojl L I ! J_p3 ^pJL 4^o«o jjp>-y b bZ-jl «UIUI “And u)/ien the disbelieving person is reaching the end of his term in the world and the beginning of his term in the

Hereafter, there will descend onto him from heaven angels with dark faces. They will bring with them Musiih, m and will sit as far from him as the sight reaches. Then the angel of death will come forward and sit right next to his head, saying, "O impure, evil soul! Depart (your body) to the anger of Allah and a wrath from Him." The soul will scatter throughout his body, and the angel of death will seize it as when the thorny branch is removed from wet wool. The angel of death will seize the soul, and when he does, they (the group of angels) will not let it stay in his hand for more than an instance, and they will wrap it in the Musiih. The most putrid smell a dead corpse can ever have on earth will emit from the soul, and the angels will ascend with it. Whenever they pass by a group of angels, they will ask, "Whose is this evil soul?" The angels will respond, "He is such person son of such person," - calling him by the worst names he was known by in the world. When they reach the lowest heaven, they will request that its door be opened for him, and their request will be denied. "For them the gates of heaven will not be opened, and they will not enter Paradise until the camel goes through the eye of the needle." [7:40] Allah will declare, "List his record in Sijjin in the lowest earth." The wicked soul will then be thrown [from heaven]. "And whoever assigns partners to Allah, it is as if he had fallen from the sky, and the birds had snatched him, or the wind had thrown him to a far off place." [22 :31] His soul will be returned to his body, and two angels will come to him, sit him up and ask him, "Who is your Lord?" He will say, "Oh, oh! I do not know." They will ask him, "What is your religion?", and he will say, "Oh, oh! I do not know." They will ask him, "What do you say about this man (Prophet Muhammad) who was sent to you?" He will say, "Oh, oh, I do not know!" A caller (Allah) will herald from heaven, "My servant has lied, so furnish him with the Fire and open a door for him to the Fire." He will find its heat and fierce hot wind. And his grave will be reduced in size, until his bones crush each other. Then, a man with a dreadful face, wearing dreadful clothes and with a disgusting l 1 ' The Musuh: a piece of thick, hard cloth made from animal hides. See Surat Al-Mutafifui 83:8.

347 Surah 14. Ibrahim (27) (Part-13) smell emitting from him will come to him, saying, "Receive the glad tidings with that which will displease you! This is the Day that you have been promised." He will ask that man, "And who are you, for yours is the face that brings about evil?" He will say, "I am your evil work." He will therefore cry, "O, my Lord! Do not commence die Hour!" Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah collected this Hadith. [1] In his Musnad, Imam 'Abd bin Humayd recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. U iip JyJ itfj 'J lij xiJl jl» v5ti : Jtf IJU dyS ids U :iJ j Ji jblL Jliii : Jli 4il xJ. i;l j^_i(ijju; <i 4il d. «Verily, when the servant is placed in his grave and his friends (or

family) depart, as he hears the sound of their shoes, two angels will come to him. They will sit him up and ask him, 'What do you say about this man (Muhammad)?' As for the believer, he will say, 'I bear witness that He is Allah's servant and Messenger.' He will be told, 'Look at your seat in the Fire, Allah has replaced it for you with a seat in Paradise.'

The Prophet said next, *«So he will see both seats. Qatadah added, "We were told that his grave will be enlarged up to seventy forearms length and will be filled with -greenery for him until the Day of Judgement."»* Muslim collected this Hadith also from 'Abd bin Humayd, while An-Nasail collected it from Yunus bin Muhammad bin Al-Mu'addah.¹³¹ Al-Hafiz Abu "Isa At-Tirmidhi, may Allah grant him mercy, recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah M said, Ahmad 4:287, Sunan Abu Dawud 3:546, An-Nasail 4:78, Ibn Majah 1 :494 Al-Muntakhab by 'Abd bin Humayd, no. 1178. Muslim no. 2870, An-Nasail, 4:97.

349 Surah 14. Ibrahim (27) (Part-13) iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter.} i Sul 'J»} 4 .1iLj 1*3 y> ^ <J JJ lij JiJi <j Cl*li 4 «i l XP * oL-UU USI>- i _^3 t fVw*^ x1p3 ic 11p3 4«i—tp lJu t _Jip i<£iju« :*J Jlij "When he will be asked in the grave, 'Who is your Lord? What is your religion? Who is your Prophet?' He will reply, 'Allah is my Lord, Islam is my religion and Muhammad is my Prophet who brought the clear proofs from Allah. I believed in him and had faith in him.' He will be told, 'You have said the truth; you have lived on this, died on it and will be resurrected on it; l 1 ' Ibn Jarir At-Tabari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that

the Prophet jg said, j^i xp ofij* "*" JJ1^ a j^P j ^P Slsjilj 4-«<ij JLP a^Lui]l L*3* j£ ^ ^ JI OLJ-X0 ^'3 ^ ^'3^ U £->j ^p U Jya 4«~.l_, Jj ,j 34 l* jp J C-it* jJ 1 4J Jlili iji-JU U ! ol^Jl ! JjA-fi Lgjp l) ! aJ jLLi -li ^3 : Jyd tiuLli IU £'jJ-ti .Jilii Ji!j :£j Jlij 4JLif ?<dp * 1+1; iuu; iaj j^i iuu j^Li Sis ^JJi cJi^l :ju5 otujlj U»L>" *jfj 4 4Jl lJfi~J Ajf -Ax-i i iJjJSl* 4 j*J4a IJ JLi : JjJLJ jl dJu <Spj 1c_* JjJi>j c—i i-Ui _^Lp : «J Jlili 1 aljJa.^t 4>l JIp 4? OjJi yu 4J iaj 4j u->»j£ <3 pi *L» cw jjJj jj 4 iLi? ^3=* * in jpI u ji 3^1 • 4} Jlij Jj U ^1 -CJJ iUuj 4 4l>J^ ^/T1-! ji-*^ 4 >- ..till .- . ' I ,y V/ 3 ' Ji 111 At-Tabari 16:596.

350 Tafstr Ibt Kathir «By He Who owns my life! The dead person hears the sound of your slippers (or shoes) when you depart and leave him. If he is a believer, the prayer will stand by his head, Zakah to his right and the fast by his left; the righteous deeds, such as charity, keeping relations with kith and kin and acts of kindness to people will stand by his feet. He will be approached from his head, and the prayer will declare, 'No entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his right, and Zakah will declare, 'There is no entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his left, and the fast will declare, 'There is no entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his feet, and the acts of righteousness will declare, 'There is no entrance from our side.' He will be commanded to sit up, and he will sit up while the sun appears to him just like when it is about to set. He will be told, 'Tell us about what we are going to ask you.' He will say, 'Leave me until I pray.' He will be told, 'You will pray, but first tell us what we want to know.' He will ask, 'What are your questions?' He will be told, 'This man who was sent among you, what do you say about him and what is your testimony about him?' He will ask, 'Muhammad?' He will be answered in the positive and he will reply, 'I bear witness that he is the Messenger of Allah and that he has brought us the proofs from our Lord. We believed in him.' He will be told, 'This is the way you lived and died and Allah willing, you will be resurrected on it.' His grave will be made wider for him seventyforearms length, and it will be filled with light. A door will also be

opened for him to Paradise. He will be told, 'Look at what Allah has prepared for you in it.' He will increase in joy and delight and then his soul will be placed with the pure souls, inside green birds eating from the trees of Paradise. The body will be returned to its origin, dust. So Allah said. *ilP?5f Gill 4 JjiTij ip: iiff££> iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter. fr"111 Ibn Hibban collected this Hadith, and his narration added the At-Tabari 16:596.*

'^£^=====^>4 t*uji/j ' i3ji vp-i Jjifl i i£& \$ *j»(jc-^yLJaj Ijljljl jl^—iaJl ^ ,v.s .s 1 ,i4^ 1-ii' 'll *-t- ' ' ' i'.X>'". JUIIiSjLJJj 0^3^—> £i&£J^(^4> ^ pPjUL^W**2'«-i disbeliever's answer and his torment. 11 ' 'Abdur-Razzaq recor- ded that Tawus said, jjai ip: <<4\& ig» 4Qli> yai j c-i3f iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world,} is in reference to La ilaha ilallah, while, iand in the Hereafter} is in reference to the questioning in the grave. 2| Qatadah commented, "As for this life, Allah will make them firm on the way of righteous- ness and good deeds, iand in the Hereafter.} in the grave."3 ' Several others among the Salaf said the same.'4 'fP tif,fP jb pj> ip\> {p P c-jj ip pi JI y fii §§ oji i^Lj jj 'pfi if 'jLj£J IjUll ijlii-j t^pj'ipi pLj itppi Jj 'pjp i28. Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet Muhammad jg and m Ibn Hibban 5:45. 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :342 At-Tabari 16:602. ' At-Jabari 16:602.

his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} 429. Hell, in which they will hum, - and what an evil place to settle in!} 430. And they set up rivals to Allah, to mislead (men) from His path! Say: "Enjoy (your brief life)! But certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire!"} The Recompense of Those Who have changed the Blessings of Allah into Disbelief Al-Bukhari said, "Allah's statement, 4Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief...}, means, do you have knowledge in. Allah said in other Ayat, iX--?)} 4Saw you not how.} and, 4Did you not think of those who went forth.} itQCf} 4A lost people} [25: 18J Ali bin 'Abdullah narrated that Sufyan said that 'Amr said that 'Ata said that he heard Ibn 'Abbas saying that, 4£ j)X Ji j ff} "4Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief}, is in reference to the people of Makkah." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu At-Tufayl said that Ibn Al- Kawwa' asked 'Ali about Allah's statement, 4those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the Iwuse of destruction} m FathAl-Bari 8:229.

353 Surah 14. Ibrahim (28-30) (Part-13) and 'Ali said that it refers to the disbelievers of Quraysh on the day of Badr.' He also said that the blessing of Allah was faith that came to the polytheists of Quraysh, and they changed this blessing into disbelief and led their people to utter destruction.'21 This includes all disbelievers, for Allah sent Muhammad | as a mercy and a blessing to all mankind. Those who accepted this blessing and were thankful for it, will enter Paradise, while those who denied it and disbelieved in it, will enter the Fire. Allah said next, & iJ-4 \VJ & iAnd they set up rivals to Allah, to mislead from His path!} meaning, they set up partners to Allah whom they worship besides Him and called the people to worship them. Allah threatened them and warned them by the words of His Prophet sg, 4 fo 4\$ay: "Enjoy (your brief life)! But certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire!"} Whatever you are able to do in this life, then do it, for no matter what will happen, iM jj iBut certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire!} for to Us will be your destination and end.' Allah said in other Ayat, OjTJU i S V iWe let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall force them to (enter) a great

torment.>[31:24] and, llj Jt J? (i. V. •>> ./ (HIV' t3ilf 4 i(A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest At-Tabari 17:6. IbnAbiHatim 12273.

355Surah 14. Ibrahim (32-34) (Part-13) will be fairness and justice.” Qatadah said, “Allah knows that in this life, there is mutual bargaining and there are friendships which people benefit from. A man chooses his friends and the reasons behind befriending them; if it was for Allah’s sake, their friendship should be maintained, but if it was for other than Allah, their friendship is bound to be cutoff.”[2 ' I say that the meaning of this, is that Allah the Exalted is declaring that on that Day, no mutual bargaining or ransom will avail anyone, even if he ransoms himself with the earth’s fill of gold if he could find that amount! No friendship or intercession shall avail one if he meets Allah while a disbeliever. Allah the Exalted said, jU Xj *£ jin Sr*. uj* ^ &Jt | 4And fear the Day when no person shall avail another, nor shall compensation be accepted from him, nor shall intercession be ofuse to him, nor shall they be helped.\$[2:123] and, % %L% £ zb J ss £ a- i \f4 \p: sM 40 you believe! Spend of that with which We have providedfor you, before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession. And it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers.^[2:254] % c£l)f . A ^ 'SPj pffoi P4 olj C o; 4 j^CJj ojrb JH11\ -P4^bp* v\$3P tla 432 . Allah is He Who has created the heavens and the earth and sends down water (rain)from the sky, and thereby brought forth fruits as provision for you ; and He has made the ships to be of service to you, that they may sail through the sea by His 111 At-Tabari 17:12. * At-Tabari 17:12.

command; and He has made rivers (also) to be of service to you.} 433. And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses, to be of service to you; and He has made the night and the day to be ofservice to you 434. And He gave you of all tluit you askedfor, and ifyou [try to] count the blessings ofAllah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed an extreme wrongdoer, ungrateful.} DescribingSome ofAllah’sTremendous Favors Allah mentions some of the favors He has done for His creatures, such as creating the heavens as a protective ceiling and the earth as a bed. He also sends down rain from the sky and, in its aftermath brings forth a variety of vegetation, fruits and plants of different colors, shapes, tastes, scents and uses. Allah also made the ships sail on the surface of the water by His command and He made the sea able to carry these ships in order that travelers can transfer from one area to another to transport goods. Allah also created the rivers that flow through the earth from one area to another as provision for the servants which they use to drink and irrigate, and for other benefits, jiiitp 4And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses}, rotating by night and by day. 7^ <j 'i) J u ujj; y} ilt is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.^[36:40] and, jiSi 3 \$ 4* pit; i'j&Zy L'> fit 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord ofall that exists!} [7:54]

The sun and the moon rotate in succession, and the night and the day are opposites, each taking from the length of the other or giving up some of its length, a a 3-4 4(Allah) merges the night into day, and merges the day into night .£ {35:13] and, 4A«d He has subjected the sun and the moon. Each running (on a fixed course) for an appointed term. Verily, He is the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving.} (39:5] Allah

said next, {And He-gave you of all that you asked for}, He has prepared for you all that you need in all conditions, and what you ask Him to provide for you. {and if you [try to] count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them.} Allah states that the servants are never able to count His blessings, let alone thank Him duly for them. In Sahdi Al- Bukhari it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg used to supplicate; 'ij % 'JZ.> iUJl ill jtflu «0 Allah ! All praise is due to You, without being able to sufficiently thank You, nor ever wish to be cutoff from You, nor ever feeling rich from relying on You; our Lord/o' 1 1 It was reported that Prophet Dawud, peace be upon him, used to say in his supplication, "O Lord! How can I ever duly thank You, when my thanking You is also a favor from You to me?" Allah the Exalted answered him, "Now, you have thanked Me sufficiently, O Dawud," meaning, Svhen you 111 Fath Al-Bdri9 :493 .

J TVmm ia&S&CUS^i^ig)fCiVt^oj ^ ^J*<4'^aC'i> tiUL.Xfr \$ 4*1^^(4a1>1>^|>t£>r ^4*^ (g&a3)£jU ^ admitted that you will never be able to duly thank Me.' <&* vj frf^L J® Hj^ igy cfr-*rb lij)» jJJ' UL itj\ v*J ->fjS J t^*S i>^ OS&* i>* it£* 3tL^ "i*/ . 1 Z*' */ **» >*i? L^UaC- *>«J ^4 |t>Ji riTi * .*_« You are indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 435. And (remember) when Ibrahim said: "O my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) one of peace and security, and keep me and my sons away from worshipping idols.} 436. "O my lord! They have indeed led astray many among mankind. But whoso follows me, he verily, is of me. And whoso disobeys me, still Ibrahim's Supplication to Allah when He brought Isma' H to Makkah Allah mentions here, while bringing forth more evidences against Arab polytheists, that the Sacred House in Makkah was established on the worship of Allah alone, without partners. He also states that Ibrahim, who establsihed the city, has disowned those who worship others besides Allah, and that he begged Allah to make Makkah peaceful and secure, <is/. jLS ill jiLf ^f} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) of peace and security,}

359 Surah 14. Ibrahim (35-36) (Part-13) and Allah accepted his supplication. Allah said in other Ayat, i&: tjz. @ ^ iHave they not seen that We have made (Makkah) a secure sanctuary .> [29:67] and, -,i-s p : (SjL» ife. ojUU yi, Jj5 4u<l» oK" ^Uo 4Verily , the first House (of worship) appointed for mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin. In it are manifest signs, the Maqdm of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security.^[3:96] Allah said here that Ibrahim supplicated, 354' ^f} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) a of peace and security,} saying, "this city", after he established it, and this is why he said afterwards, 4AU praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'il and Ishaq.} [14:39] It is well-known that Ismail was thirteen years older than Ishaq. When Ibrahim took Ismail and his mother to Makkah, while Ismail was still young enough to nurse, he supplicated to Allah, li* j Cjj} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) a place of peace and security.} [2:126] as we in explained in Surat Al-Baqarah. Ibrahim then said, 4and keep me and my sons away from worshipping idols.} It is proper for whoever supplicates to Allah to also ask for the benefit of his parents and offspring, as well as himself. Ibrdhim next mentioned that many among mankind were led astray because of idols, and he disowned those who worship them and referred their matter to Allah; if Allah wills, He will

punish them, and if He wills. He will forgive them. Isa, peace be upon him, said similar words, *l? ilf You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily, You, only You are the Almighty, the All- Wise.>[5:1 18] This supplication refers this and all matters to Allah, not that it is

actually going to happen. ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ recited Ibrahim’s supplication, 40 my Lord! They have indeed led astray many among mankind.}, and the supplication of ‘Isa, if You punish them, they are Your servants .} [5:118] then raised his hands and said, «O Allah, Save my Ummah! O, Allah, Save my Ummah! O, Allah, Save my Ummah! and cried. Allah said to the angel Jibril, “O Jibril, go to Muhammad, and Your Lord has more knowledge, and ask him what makes him cry.” Jibril came to the Prophet ﷺ and asked him, and he repeated to him what he said (in his supplication). Allah said, “Go to Muhammad and tell him this; *We will make you pleased with your Ummah, O Muhammad, and will not treat them in away you dislike. •JLJ’ Wj oLto X£ gjj fc. j zil J-& 4*2^’ <Ji tSyf 437. "O our Lord! I have made some of my offspring dwell in an uncultivable valley by Your Sacred House in order, O our Lord, that they may perform Salah. So fill some hearts among his Muslim 1 :19 1

362 Surah 14. Ibrahim (37) (Part-13) men with love towards them, and (O Allah) provide them with fruits so that they may give thanks.} This Ayah indicates that this was different supplication than the first one that Ibrahim said when he left Hajar and her son Ismail in Makkah, before the Sacred House was built. This prayer, it appears, was said after the House was built, begging Allah and seeking His favor, and He is the Exalted and Most Honored. Ibrahim said here. iby Your Sacred House...} then he, Cj} 40 our Lord, that they may perform Salah.} Ibn Jarir At-Tabari commented that this, “Refers to his earlier statement, 4the Sacred...},” meaning, You have made this House Sacred so that people establish the prayer next to it,’ ^br «j;&’ »as\$ 4So fill some hearts among men with love towards them,} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said, “Had Ibrahim said, The hearts of mankind’, Persians, Romans, the Jews, the Christians and all other people would have gathered around it.’ * However, Ibrahim said, 4o& U} 4among men}, thus making it exclusive to Muslims only. He said next, £^} 4and (O Allah) provide them with fruits} *** See Al-Bukhari no. 3364, where it is clear that Ibrahim said this supplication when he first arrived in Makkah leaving his wife and Ismail ApTabari 17:25-26.

in order that they may be helped in obeying You, and because this is a barren valley; bring to them fruits that they might eat. Allah accepted Ibrahim’s supplication, ugU Uy ijl£2 iHave We not established for them a secure sanctuary (Makkah), to which are brought fruits of all kinds, a provision from Ourselves.} [28:57] This only indicates Allah’s compassion, kindness, mercy and blessing, in that there are no fruit producing trees in the Sacred City, Makkah, yet all kinds of fruits are being brought to it from all around; this is how Allah accepted the supplication of the Khalil - Allah’s intimate friend, Prophet Ibrahim, peace be upon him. <4 Vj urfjfi 4 ‘Uf- 02 ji’ j6 tjfo. b) ly jn*- L JW «l£[, JjSj fj 438. "O o«r Lord! Certainly, You know what we conceal and what we reveal. Nothing on the earth or in the heaven is hidden from Allah."} 439. "All praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'il and Ishaq. Verily, my Lord is indeed the All-Hearer of invocations."} 440. "O my Lord! Make me one who performs Salah, and (also) from my offspring, our Lord! And accept my invocation."} "Our Lord! Forgive me and my parents, and (all) the believers on the Day when the reckoning will be established."} Ibn Jarir At-Tabari said, “Allah said that Ibrahim, His Khalil, said, tJ \£j} 40 our Lord! Certainly, You know what we conceal and what we reveal.} meaning, You know the intention behind my supplication for

the people of this town, seeking Your pleasure in sincerity to You. You know all things, apparent and hidden, and nothing escapes Your knowledge on the earth or in heaven.” He next praised and thanked his Lord the Exalted and Most Honored for granting him offspring after he became old, 4A// praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'it (Ishmael) and Ishaq (Isaac). Verily, my Lord is indeed the All-Hearer of invocations.} *He accepts the supplication of those who invoke Him, and has accepted my invocation when I asked Him to grant me offspring.’ Ibrahim said next, 40 my Lord! Make me one who performs Salah,}, preserving its obligations and limits, i^o6} iand (also) from my offspring,}, make them among those who establish the prayer, as well, ^} iour Lord! And accept my invocation.}, all of my invocation which ' I invoked You with herein, iOur Lord! Forgive me and my parents,} Ibrahim said this before he declared himself innocent from his father, after he became sure that he was an enemy of Allah, iand the believers}, all of them. 44>L^»J' f_A* 'E} ion the Day when the reckoning will be established.} on the Day when You will reckon Your servants and recompense or reward them for their deeds - good for good and evil for evil.

• > -r *;• /ji Ci IpM fcs; iii -tuZ 'it ^>-^1 i>: *J oJ: fax# 442. Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day ivhen the eyes will stare in horror.} 443. (They will be) hastening forward with necks outstretched, their heads raised up (towards the sky), their gaze returning not towards than and their hearts empty.} Allah gives Respite to the Disbelievers and is never unaware of what They do Allah says, ‘O Muhammad, do not think that Allah is unaware of what the unjust disbelievers do. Do not think because Allah gave them respite and delayed their punishment that He is unaware or ignoring punishing them for what they do. Rather, Allah keeps full account of this for them and keeps it on record against them, 4but He gives than respite up to a Day whai the eyes will stare in horror.} from the horror of the Day of Resurrection.’ Allah next mentions how they will all be raised up from their graves and hurriedly gathered for the Day of Gathering, icu^} 4/tasteningforward}, in a hurry. Allah said in other Ayat, 4^ J! ¥ 4Hastening towards the caller.} [54:8] 40n that Day mankind will follow strictly Allah's caller, no crookedness will they show him.} [20:108] until, && :j\$ 4And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the

Sustainer.} [20:111] Allah said: another Ayat, ui (5^ 4The Day when they will come out of the graves quickly. [70:43] Allah said next, iwith necks outstretched> meaning, raising their heads up, according to Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and several others.*11 Allah said next, '4>.# itheir gaze returning not towards them> meaning, their eyes are staring in confusion, trying not to blink because of the horror and tremendous insights they are experiencing, and fear of what is going to strike them, we seek refuge with Allah from this end. This is why Allah said. 4and their hearts empty.} meaning, their hearts are empty due to extreme fear and fright. Qatadah and several others said that the places of their hearts are empty then, because the hearts will ascend to the throats due to extreme fear. 121 Allah said next to His Messenger sg, (4-^j oj ^ Si ? j&J l ,h—^ o;Ji j iij <3jEl O^J xej liJfc ij <(44. And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them; then the wrongdoers will say: "Our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your call and 111 At-Tabari 17:31-32. 121 At-Tabari 17:34.

follow the Messengers!" (It will be said:) "Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter)."} 445. "And you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves, and it was clear to you how We dealt with them. And We put forth (many) parables for you."} 446.

Indeed, they planned their plot, and their plot was with Allah, though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} There will be no Respite after the Coming of the Torment Allah mentions what those who committed injustice against themselves will say when they witness the torment, g-Sj T2j} 4Our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your call and follow the Messengers!} Allah said in other Ayat, 4Until, when death comes to one of them, he says: "My Lord! Send me back."}[23:99] and, 4fi\$ \p: (\$£} 40 you who believe! Let not your properties divert you.} (63:9-10] Allah described the condition of the wrongdoers on the Day of Gathering, when He said, 4And if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads.} (32:12], 'tj je ijij i] Ztj jf} 4If you could but see when they will be held over the Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Ayat of Our Lord..."!} [6:27] and.

4Q. t iTherein they will cry.} (35:27) Allah refuted their statement here, oi £& Jt '5^=^ |^3'^ 4Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave> Allah says, *Had you not vowed before, that your previous state will not change, that there will be no Resurrection or Reckoning? Therefore, taste this torment because of what you vowed before.' Mujahid commented that, 4\$£> Cii £\$ ithat you would not leave.} refers to leaving this worldly life to the Hereafter. 111 Allah also said, iAnd they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up him who dies.} [16:38] Allah said next. ^ fk^S jit C/Jii 4 i^X-4 J^VTp iAnd you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves, and it was clear to you how We had dealt with them. And We put forth (many) parables for you.} Allah says, "you have witnessed or heard of the news of what happened to the earlier disbelieving nations, but you did not draw a lesson from their end, nor did what We punished them with provide an example for you," iPerfect wisdom but the wamers benefit then not.^ (54:5) Shu*bah narrated that Abu Ishaq said that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Dabil said that 'Ali bin Abi Talib commented on Allah's statement, m Al-Tabari 17:36.

368 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} "He who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord, took two eaglets and raised them until they became adult eagles. Then he tied each eagle's leg to a wooden box with ropes and left them go hungry. He and another man sat inside the wooden box and raised a staff with a piece of meat on its tip. So, the two eagles started flying. The king asked his companion to tell him what he was seeing, and he described the scenes to him, until he said that he saw the earth as a fly. So, the king brought the staff closer to the eagles and they started landing slowly. This is why Allah said, Jjj3pp SIS jp) "though their plot was hardly one to remove the mountains from their places." Mujahid also mentioned that this story was about Nebuchadnezzar, and that when the king's sight was far away from earth and its people, he was called, 'O tyrant one! Where are you headed to?' He became afraid and brought the staff closer to the eagles, which flew faster with such haste that the mountains almost shook from the noise they made. The mountains were almost moved from their places, so Allah said, 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places Ibn Jurayj narrated that Mujahid recited this Ayah in a way that means, "though their plot was such as to remove the mountains from their places." However, Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, 4J1^' ii* jff} ithough their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} indicates that their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places. Similar was said by Al-Hasan Al- At-Jabari 17:39. 121 At-Jabari 17:39.

Basri. Ibn Jarir reasoned that, "Associating others with Allah and disbelieving in Him, which they brought upon themselves, did not bother the mountains nor other creatures. Rather, the harm of their actions came to haunt them." I (Ibn Kathir) said, this meaning is similar to Allah's statement, 3cl) p m^ JA a \$And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth, nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height.\$[17:37] There is another way of explaining this Ayah] 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that, iij jjJj 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.\$ refers to their Shirk, for Allah said in another Ayah, 4*^ ^Whereby the heavens are almost tom.\$ ll] [19:90] Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said similarly.12 ' >Aff ' > t* ' /f 4. ,4' " 4i[p.^4i^ A hirej i47. So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His Messengers. Certainly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution.\$ 448. On the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens, and they (all creatures) will appear before Allah, the One, the Irresistible. Allah never breaks a Promise Allah affirms His promise, ^t43lImj -oil uw*- ys>y 4So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His 111 At-Tabari 17:41. (2> At-Tabari 17 :41

Messengers.} His promise to grant them victory in this life and on the Day when the Witnesses shall come forth. Allah affirms that He is All-Able and that nothing He wills escapes His power and none can resist Him. Allah affirms that He is Able to exact retribution from those who disbelieve in Him and deny Him, \$Woe that Day to the deniers!}(77:15) Allah said here, iOn the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens, meaning. His promise shall come to pass on the Day when the earth will be changed to an earth other than this earth that we know and recognize. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Sahl bin Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah said, pj. JU udi «On the Day of Resurrection, the people will be gathered on a white (barren), flat earth just like the wheat bread, it has no recognizable features for anyone .n111 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah said, "I was the first among all people who asked the Messenger of Allah jg; about this Ayah, iOn the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens,} saying, 'O Allah's Messenger! Where will the people be then?' He said, Fathal-Bah 11 :379, Muslim 4:2150.

371Surah 14. Ibrahim (47-48) (Part-13) •On the Sfrat.®" ' Muslim, but not Al-Bukhari, collected this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi and Ibn M&jah also recorded it, and At- Tirmidhi said "Hasan Sahih")2^ Imam Muslim bin Al-Hajjaj recorded in his Sahih that Thawban the servant of the Messenger of Allah jg; said, "I was standing next to the Messenger of Allah when a Jewish rabbi came to him and said, "Peace be to you, O Muhammad.' I pushed him with such a force that almost caused him to fall down and he asked me why I did that. I said, "Why did you not say, 'O Messenger of Allah?' The Jew said, We call him by the name which his family gave him.' The Messenger of Allah M said, ii i iJ-jh «Muhammad is indeed the name which myfamily gave me.» The Jew said, 1 came to ask you about something.' The Messenger of Allah £§ replied, oWould it benefit you ifI replied to your question ?» He said, 1 will hear it with my ear.' The Messenger of Allah jj§ poked the ground with a staffhe had and said, .jii *Askj The Jew said, "Where will the people be when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will the heavens?' The Messenger of Allah said, ilj&i : Jlii ?3jLfl Jji :JU jja SS olj ^ p I JUi l jit SiS ^jJl I : Jli ? UjJJ J Uj :JU «J>Jl :JU . Jls l*j JJ. :JU ?«JU U :JU «l«l fi^ "ill l j^- 1 V jp JSI^l cJ iJU v 111 Ahmad 6:35. ?irdt originally means * a road'; it also means the bridge that will be laid across Hellfire for the people to pass over on the Day ofJudgement . It is described as sharper than a sword and thinner than a

hair. It will have hooks over it to snatch the people. 121 Muslim 4 :2 150 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :548, Ibn Majah 2 : 1430

• Jli • 1 * JI* *?d3Lo-i>* d)l ;Jij . d)^>-j ji ySj UUU-I lip i'jA^>\ jf^Jl JUj t *Ut : Jla ijJ^Jt dtfU *J^)'& jfcii#* «ip *Ju;*^ tfif cjf^ii^ ji^Ji^ 3>*“J JUi lOj-ajl jjjJ Ulilj O- i .l.^ di) Jli Jjil oi^i till J>- *4 ii>^ f-4J ^*j *<^ ^3^-- j* '-i* jiJ» :2|| <ii I<| ill I “Jn /he darkness before the Bridge (Jasr). * He asked, *Who will be the first to pass it?’ He said, “The poor emigrants (Muhajirin). * He asked, “What will their (refreshment) be when they enter Paradise?’ He said, iThe caul offish liver. He asked, *What will they have after that?’ He said, *A bull of Paradise which grazed through its pathways will be slaughtered for them.* He asked, ‘From what will they drink?’ He said, iFrom a fountain whose name is Salsabil .» He said, ‘You have said the truth. I have come to ask you something about which none of the inhabitants of the earth knows, with the exception of a Prophet or one or two other men.’ He said, *Would you benefit by me informing you about it?’ He replied, 7 would listen. I have come to ask you about the child.’ He jfe said, *The fluid of the man is white, and the woman's is yellow. When they meet, if the discharge of the man is greater than that of the woman, then it becomes a male, by Allah's permission. W7ien the womans discharge is greater than the man's, it becomes afemale by Allah's permission .» The Jew said, You have told the truth and are indeed a Prophet.’ Then he left. So Allah’s Messenger jg said; «He asked me such things that I had no knowledge of it until Allah gave it to we.® Allah said next, 4k iand they will appear before Allah}, describing when the creatures will be resurrected before Allah from their graves, m Muslim no. 315.

Jr emm n\ mm if3!JLLi4>'3-<J' p-f~>K o'UlJjJlj^/^**[> ,* ? - «i _> ji»«c4«_- ,_)—^ ^JlJg j^lLl Jjjj cEij;*jE3 3Ci% , > ""si' *. >VmV't""^ \<.x *. j-~*i >^<-S_A> t) (^liy \j-~*^ AiW* <40}i/*- \$aS^iw Jjjjwllj^Dl '3l» swift at reckoning.> itiie One, the Irresisti- ble.) Who has full power and control over all things and to Whom the necks and minds are subservient. y^*Ji Or^>vJ' <Er*Jr o' ^+Lp 4 v >>^ >> . , '1 *s v.«%jLiN cs-^J ylr" lljLT 12 .jJi j^ Sit »jt g/i iii j[449. And you will see the criminals that Day, Muqarranun (bound to- gether) in fetters.) 450. Their garments will be of Qatiran (tar), and fire will cover their faces.) 451 . That Allah may requite each person ac- cording to what he has earned. Truly, Allah is The Condition of the criminals on the Day of Resurrection Allah said. % J&i jS?E» 40n the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens} ‘and the creations will be brought before their Lord, and you, O Muhammad, will witness the criminals who committed the crimes of Kufr and mischief,’

<&*} {Muqarranin} bound together, each with his or her like, just as Allah said, yn4 {Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions.} [37:22] {And when the souls are joined with their bodies.}[81:7], ds&l j&d b'6& \$1 Z\$} {And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction.} [25:13] and. 4 4^ {And also the Shayatin from the Jinn (including) every kind of builder and diver, and also others bound in fetters.^[38:37-38] Allah said next, {Their garments will be ofQatiran (pitch),} that is used to coat camels. Qatadah commented that Qatirdn (tar) is one of the fastest objects to catch fire. Ibn ‘Abbas used to say that the Qatirdn, mentioned in the Ayah, is dissolved lead.111 It is possible that this Ayah reads as: (yU** hi refering to heated lead that has reached tremendous heat, according to Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin

Jubayr Al-Hasan and Qatadah.[21 Allah said next, {j}j& ££}} {and fire will cover their faces}, which is similar to His other At-Tabari 17:56. At-Tabari 17:55-56.

Sarah 14. Ibrahim (49-51) (Part-13 statement, iThe Fire will bunt theirfaces, and therein they will grin, with displaced lips.>[23: 104] Imam Ahmad recorded that Yahya bin Abi Ishaq said that Aban bin Yazfd said that Yahya bin Abi Kathlr said that Zayd bin Abi Salam said that Abu Malik Al-Ash‘ari said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said, j> j y be^ Jt g'J1 Jj siZ \\\ iAsilJj ,cdi JU UdJtj 3l A AA* be J'o- y 1^ \y. fis «Fo«r characteristics from the time of Jahiliyyah will remain in my Ummah, since they will not abandon them : boasting about their family lineage, discrediting family ties, seeking rain through the stars, and wailingfor their dead. Verily, ifshe who wails, dies before she repents from her behavior, she will be resurrected on the Day of Resurrection while wearing a dress of Qatiran and a cloak ofmange. >llJ Muslim collected this Hadith.l2] Allah said next, tyz's lit iThat Allah may requite each person according to what he has earned. meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said in another Ayah, i\U A iThat He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done.} [53:3 lj Allah said here, iTruly, Allah is swift at reckoning.} 111 Ahmad 5:342. * Muslim 2 :644

when He wills to reckon a servants of His, for He knows everything and nothing ever escapes His observation. Verily, His power over all of His creation is the same as His power over one creature, 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as a single person.^ (31:28] And this is why Mujahid said, 4swift at reckoning}, means “keeping count.” .”A 452 . This (Qur'an) is a Messagefor mankind (and a clear proof against them), in order that they may be warned thereby, and that they may know that He is the only One God and that men ofunderstanding may take heed.} Allah states that this Qur’an is a Message for mankind, 4(So) that 1 may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} [6:19] This Qur’an is for all mankind and the Jinns, just as Allah said in the beginning of this Surah, QfA. 4Alif-Lam-Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light.} \14:1] Allah said next, 4in order that they may be warned thereby}, or to receive and draw lessons from it, 4Vj '42O£&>

and that they may know that He is the only One God} using its proofs and evidences that testify that there is no true deity except Allah, iand that men of understanding may take heed.} meaning those who have good minds.

Surah 15: Al-Hijr

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2919–2965]

Opening >> about the Jahannamiyyun (the sinners among the believers who will stay in Hell for some time), when they (the disbelievers) see them being brought out of Hell.” iHow much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been Muslims. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn ‘Abbas and Anas bin Malik explained that this Ayah refers to the Day when Allah will detain the sinful Muslims in Hell along with the idolaters. He said: “The idolaters will say to them, “What you used to worship on earth has not helped you.’ Then by virtue of His mercy, Allah will be angry for their sake, and He will remove them [from it]. That is when <*0*^ \ \$ i !£S- '4% O,} 4How much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been Muslims}. ”*21 iLeave them to eat and enjoy} this is a stem and definitive threat for them, like His saying, j] iSay : "Enjoy your brief life! But certainly, your destination is the Fire!"} [14:30] 4(0 disbelievers!) Eat and enjoy yourselves (in this worldly life) for a little while. Verily, you are the guilty>[77:46] Allah says: <£.V(4let them be preoccupied with false hope.} i.e., distracted from repentance and turning to Allah, for 4^r^t Sf->} At-Tabari 17:62. At-Tabari 17:62.

381 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (4-9) (Part-14 48. We do not send the angels down except with the truth, and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!) 49. Verily, We, it is We Who revealed the Dhikr (i.e. the Qur'an) and surely We will guard it (from corruption).} The Accusation that the Prophet^ was a Madman and Demands for Him to bring down Angels Allah tells us about the disbelief, arrogance and stubbornness of the disbelievers as reflected in their words: 40 you (Muhammad) to whom the Dhikr (the Qur'an) has been revealed!} i.e., the one who claims to receive it. i&i5 iVerily, you are a mad man!} i.e., by your invitation to us to follow you and leave the way of our forefathers. 4&pi C }} 4Why do you not bring angels to us} i.e., to bear witness to the accuracy of what you have brought to us is true, if you are really telling the truth? This is similar to what Pharaoh said: f (kt T 4Why then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him, or angels sent along with him?}[43:53). And Allah said: tsj \$ uu) dkk-k v cjf juj^ 4And those who do not expect a meeting, with Us (i.e., those , who deny the Day of Resurrection and the life of the Hereafter), say : "Why are not the angels sent down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride. On the Day that they do see the angels - there will be no good news given on that day to the guilty. And they (angels) will say: "All kinds of glad tidings are forbidden for you."} (25:21-22) For this reason Allah said:

382 TafsTr Ibn KathTr w n & c» iWe do not send the angels down except with the truth, and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!} Mujahid said in this Ayah -Ji233\$ c> iWe do not send the angels down except with the truth “[i.e.,J with the Message and the punishment.” 1 Then Allah,

may He be exalted, stated that He is the One Who revealed the Dhikr to him, which is the Qur'an, and He is protecting it from being changed or altered. "i 1\$ s)yj os pjji 44 ja tS&jt ^ % -X jfoS. V vjiS a 4# <@y>" 410. Indeed, We sent (Messengers) before you (O Muhammad) amongst the earlier communities. ill. And there never came a Messenger to them but that they mocked him. ill. Thus We allow it to enter the hearts of the guilty. il3. They would not believe in it (the Qur'an); and already the example of the ancients has gone forth.} The Idolaters of Every Nation made a Mockery of their Messengers Consoling His Messenger ig for the rejection of the disbelieving Quraysh, Allah says that He has sent Messengers before him to the nations of the past, and no Messenger came to a nation but they rejected him and mocked him. Then He tells him that He lets disbelief enter the hearts of those sinners who are too stubborn and too arrogant to follow His guidance. ^ yjii <4 /S3LLa4uT> iThus We allow it to enter the hearts of the guilty.} m At-Tabari 17:68.

Anas and Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that this referred to Shirk. ,1) ili cii- iand already the example of the ancients has gone forth> meaning the destruction wrought by Allah on those who rejected His Messengers, and how He saved His Prophets and their followers in this world and in the Hereafter, is well known. 414. And even if We opened to them a gate to the heavens and they were to continue ascending through it (all day long).) 415. They would surely say (in the evening): "Our eyes have been (as if) dazzled (we have not seen any angel or heaven). Nay, we are a people bewitched.") The Stubborn Disbelievers will never believe, no matter what Signs and Wonders They see Allah explains the extent of their disbelief and stubborn resistance to the truth by stating that even if a door to heaven were to be opened for them, and they were to be taken up through it, they would still not believe. Rather, they would say: 4&4 I4> 40ur eyes have been (as if) dazzled.) Mujahid, Ibn Kathir and Ad-Dahhak said, "[this means] our vision has been blocked."121 Qatadah narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "(this means] our eyesight has been taken away." Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "(this means] we were confused and put under a spell. "31 40ur eyes have been (as if) dazzled.) At-Tabari 17:70. Af-Tabari 17:74. At-Jabari 17:75.

rvr j&j l^j^3 ><]r if*' .i *£ - i"^^*" - x >f_> ** < " 0*^0"!% ^^jilsjaLv{/<&£>Uj,iLT^i~ ^y£&gS3 Tafefr Ibn Kathlr 0—i^nUjili.-UJ_>|p(CT^ci^ 1«U^j»A/si,^y)<iL_> ^sL^CLIj —•^'Ujii^^'O; (ji^ss*4S0HUIJU»_j I^I jj*^4 j^agsga ^ Ibn Zayd said: "The one who is dazzled [lit. intoxicated] is the one who cannot reason." ££> &3\^ Gw wj> 0^S l® *9+V^\$ OJ jat &:f i~_';^j 1\$Wju jT OJ lj Gwl> (sf>J L(j ^3 LWj £3p>ui>* }j^ Ti^<JU£/. r j^—' i>*J <_>-£ 416. And indeed, We have put the big stars in the heaven and We beautified it for the beholders.4 417. And We have guarded it (near heaven) from every outcast Shay-tan (devil). 418. Except him (devil) who steals the hearing, then he is pursued by a clear flaming fire.} 419. And We have spread out the earth, and have placed firm mountains in it, and caused all kinds of things to grow in it, in due proportion.} 420. And in it We have provided means of living, for you and for those whom you provide not.} The Power of Allah and His Signs in the Heavens and on Earth To those who ponder, and look repeatedly at the dazzling signs and wonders that are to be seen in the creation, Allah mentions His creation of the heavens, with their immense height, and both the fixed and moving heavenly bodies with

which He has adorned it. Here, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Buruj [big stars] refers to the heavenly bodies . 1 11 (I say): This is like the Ayah : 4Blessed be He Who has placed the big stars in the

heavens . [25:61] ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi said: “Buruj here refers to sentinel fortresses.”¹²¹ He made the “shooting stars” to guard it against the evil devils who try to listen to information conveyed at the highest heights. If any devil breaches it and advances hoping to listen, a clear “shooting star” comes to him and destroys him. He may already have passed on whatever he heard before the fire hit him, to another devil below him; the latter will then take it to his friends [among humans], as is stated in the Sahlh. Explaining this Ayah, Al-Bukhari reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet sg said: c2jJ> jILUI J» yS I ill I bln 'yue JLLJL. «When Allah decrees any matter in heaven, the angels beat their wings in submission to His Word, [with a sound like] a chain [beating] on a smooth rock.” (‘Ali and other subnarrators said, “The sound reaches them.”) “When the fright leaves their (angels’) hearts, they (angels) are asked: What did your Lord say?’ They respond: “The truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.’ So those who hope to hear something listen, and they are standing one above the other.” Sufyan [the narrator] described them with a gesture, spreading the fingers of his right hand and holding it in such a way that the fingers were above one another. “Sometimes the flaming fire hits one of these listeners before he is able to convey what he has heard to the one who is beneath him, and he is burned up, or sometimes the fire does not hit him until he has pit on to the one beneath him, At-Tabari 17:77. Al-Baghawi 3 :45

so he brings it to the earth.” Perhaps Sufyan said: “...until it reaches the earth and he puts it into the mouth of the sorcerer or fortune-teller, so that after telling a hundred lies he gets something right, and the people say, T)id he not tell us that on such and such a day such and such would happen, and we found it to be the truth among the statements which were heard from heaven.”¹¹¹ Then Allah mentions His creation of the earth and how He spread it out, and the firm mountains, valleys, lands and sands that he has placed in it, and the plants and fruits that He causes to grow in their appropriate locations. t'y¥ yfr tall kinds of things in due proportion.> Ibn ‘Abbas said that this means with their predetermined proportions. This was also the opinion of Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, Abu Malik, Mujahid, Al-Hakim bin ‘Utaybah, Al- Hasan bin Muhammad, Abu Salih and Qatadah . Ijj j£3 \$And We have provided therein means of living, for you\$ Here Allah mentions that He created the earth with different means of provisions and livelihood of all kinds. 4andfor those whom you provide not.\$ Mujahid said, “This refers to the riding animals and the cattle.”¹³¹ Ibn Jarir said, “They are slaves, men and women, as well as the animals and the cattle. The meaning is that Allah, may He be exalted, is reminding them of the ways of earning provision that He has made easy for them, and of the animals that He has subjugated for them to ride and to eat, and the slaves from whom they benefit, but the provision of all of these comes from Allah alone.”¹⁴¹ 111 Fath Al-Bari8 :23 1 121 At-Tabari 17:79-81. 131 At-Tabari 17:82. 141 At-Tabari 17:82.

&' irfj £3^#%% £^ fc5 1C £2Ji Si a#" *' "" " Z% o* 2S^ ££ tfj gja^t n. ‘>»~ - *> *1 j 421 . And there is not a thing, but the supplies for it are with Us, and We do not send it down but in a known measure.} 422 . And We send the winds fertilizing, then We cause the water to descend from the sky, and We give it to you to drink, and it is not you who are the owners of its supply.} 423 . And certainly We! It is We Who give life, and cause death, and We are the Inheritors .} 424 . And indeed, We know the first generations of you who have passed away, and indeed, We know the present generations of you (mankind), and also those who will come afterwards.} And verily, your Lord will gather them together. Truly, He is Most Wise, (and) Knowing.} The Supplies for All Things are with Allah Allah tells us that

He is the Owner of all things, and that everything is easy for Him. He has the supplies for all things with Him. *Cj} iand We do not send it down but in a known measure.*} meaning, as He wills and as He wants. Doing so out of His great wisdom and mercy towards His servants, in a way that He is under no obligation to do. But He has decreed mercy for Himself. Yazld bin Abi Ziyad reported from Abu Juhayfah that ‘Abdullah said: “No year has more rain than another, but Allah divides the rain between them as He wills, it rains here a year and there a year. Then he recited: *lixjji ur j* d}j} i*And there is not a thing, but the supplies for it are with Us...}

388 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr Reported by Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ Benefits of the Winds 4*And We send the winds fertilizing* i.e., fertilizing the clouds so that they give rain, and fertilizing the trees so that they open their leaves and blossoms. These winds are mentioned here in the plural form because they give results, unlike the barren wind (*Ar-Rih Al-’Aqim*, see *Adh- Dhariyat* 51:41), which is mentioned in the singular and described as barren since it does not produce anything; because results can only be produced when there are two or more things. *iAnd We sent the winds fertilizing.* ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud said, “The wind is sent bearing water from the sky, then it fertilizes the clouds until rain begins to generously fall, just as the milk of the pregnant camel flows generously.”¹²¹ This was also the opinion of Ibn ‘Abbas, Ibrahim An-Nakha*i and Qatadah.¹³ Ad-Dahhak said: “Allah sends it to the clouds and it gets fertilized and becomes full of water.”¹⁴¹ Tjbayd bin TJmayr Al-Laythi said: “Allah sends the wind which stirs up the earth, then Allah sends the wind which raises clouds, then Allah sends the wind which forms clouds, then Allah sends the fertilizing wind which pollinates the trees. Then he recited, *cf9’ {And We sent the winds fertilizing,*^ ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 17:84. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 17-86. ¹³¹ At-Tabari 17:87-88. ¹⁴¹ At-Tabari 17:88 ¹⁵¹ Ibid.

389 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (21-25) (Part-14 Fresh Water is a Blessing from Allah *iand We give it to you to drink,*) This means, “and We send it down to you fresh and sweet, so that you can drink it; if We had wished. We could have made it salty (and undrinkable)”, as Allah points out in another Ayah in Surat Al-Waqi‘ah, where He says: *iill jj Ji jp’f j, jjifc %’\$) ad iTell Me! The water that you drink, is it you who cause it to come down from the rain clouds, or are We the cause of it coming down? If We willed, We verily could make it salty (and undrinkable), why then do you not give thanks (to Allah)?* (56:68-70). And Allah says: *f3 & Lilt sfj* JjJ xs& j>) iHe it is Who sends water down from the sky; from it you drink and from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.* (16:10) *iZ&k fi V;)* *iand it is not you who are the owners of its supply.*) The meaning is, “You are not taking care of it; rather We send it down and take care of it for you, making springs and wells flourish on the earth.” If Allah so willed, He could make it disappear, but by His mercy He sends it down and makes it fresh and sweet, maintaining the springs, wells, rivers and so on, so that they may drink from it all year long, water their livestock and irrigate their crops. The Power of Allah to initiate and renew Creation *o*l) ty)) iAnd certainly We! We it is Who give life, and cause death,*) Here Allah tells us of His power to initiate creation and renew it. He is the One Who brings life to creatures out 'of

390 Tafslr Ibn Kathir nothingness, then He causes them to die, then He will resurrect gill of them on the Day when He will gather them together. He also tells us that He will inherit the earth and everyone on it, and then it is to Him that they will return. Then He tells us about His perfect knowledge of them, the first and the last of them. He says *ip.*£3 ££ i*And indeed, We know the first generations of you who had

passed away...}. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The first generations are all those who have passed away since the time of Adam. The present generations and those who will come afterward refer to those who are alive now and who are yet to come, until the Day of Resurrection.” Something similar was narrated from ‘Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka‘b, Ash-Sha‘Ta and others.*2 Ibn Jarir reported from Muhammad bin Abi Ma’shar, from his father, that he heard ‘Awn bin ‘Abdullah discussing the following Ayah with Muhammad bin Ka‘b: %pt*£3 i And indeed, We know the first generations of you who had passed away, and indeed, We know the present generations of you (mankind), and also those who will come afterwards}, and it was stated that it refers to the rows for prayer. Muhammad bin Ka‘b said, “This is not the case. ipi iix &;} i And indeed, We know the first generations of you who had passed away} it refers to those who are dead or have been killed, and; ib^} i and also those who will come afterwards} meaning those who have yet to be created. I 1 * At-Tabari 17:91. > At-Tabari 17:90-92.

393 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (26-27) (Part-14) 4 And verily your Lord will gather them together. Truly, He is Most Wise, (and) Knowing}.” ‘Awn bin ‘Abdullah said, “May Allah help you and reward you with good.”111 J5 J? 5‘p’f / / V 426. And indeed, We created man from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud.} 427. And the }inn, We created earlier from the smokeless flame of fire.} The Substances from which Mankind and Jinns were created Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Salsal means dry mud.121 The apparent meaning is similar to the Ayah: cc o* c jfc-} 4 He created man (Adam) from sounding clay like the potter’s clay, And He created the jinns from a smokeless flame of fire.} (55:14-15) It was also reported from Mujahid that, 4^,} idried (sounding) clay} means “putrid”,131 but it is more appropriate to interpret an Ayah with another Ayah. p~ ^} i of altered mud} means the dried clay that comes from mud, which is soil. “Altered” here means smooth. /A’ i » o; 4 And the jinn, We created earlier} means before creating humans. At-Tabari 17:90. At-Tabari 17:96. [3] At-Tabari 17:97.

' i ifrom the smokeless flame of fire Ibn ‘Abbas said, “It is the smokeless flame that kills.” 11 ' Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi said that Shu*bah narrated to them from Abu Ishaq, who said: “I visited Umar Al-Asamm when he was sick, and he said: ‘Shall I not tell you a Hadith that I heard from ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud? He said: This smokeless flame is one of the seventy parts of the smokeless fire from which the Jinn were created. Then he recited, i o; Jj j; 4 And the Jinn, We created earlier from the smokeless flame of fire}.” The following is found in the Sahih, •Juej f Si JI>-j ijU {a jt>JI C~IL> -j i jy iSySfru, JI n The angels were created from light, the Jinn were created from a smokeless flame of fire, and Adam was created from that which has been described to you V3’ The Ayah is intended to point out the noble nature, good essence and pure origin of Adam. \ij p- ot & & j£\ pi Jli TT^ J yl ,ill U Jli ^ ofri jl zi) fr- J* J.C«i .o Ji /Oili. —iJ 428. And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: “I am going to create a man (Adam) from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud.”} 429. “So, when I have fashioned him completely and breathed into him (Adam) of My spirit (the soul which I created for (1 > At-Tabari 17:99. 121 At-Tabari 16:21. Muslim 4:2294

393 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (34-38) (Part-14) him,) then fall down, prostrating yourselves before him.”} 430. So the angels prostrated themselves, all of them together. 431. Except Iblis (Shaytan) - he refused to be among the prostrate.} 432. (Allah) said: “O Iblis! What is your reason for not being among the prostrate?” 433. [Iblis] said: “I am not one to prostrate myself to a human, whom You created from

dried (sounding) clay of altered mud."} The creation of Adam, the Command to the Angels to prostrate to Him, and the Rebellion of Iblis Allah informs us of how He mentioned Adam to His angels before He created him, and how He honored him by commanding the angels to prostrate to him. He mentions how His enemy Iblis, amidst all the angels, refused to prostrate to him out of envy, disbelief, stubbornness, arrogance, and false pride. This is why Iblis said: * fr ce, jSl ^ty 41 am not one to prostrate myself to a human, whom You created from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud.} this is like when he said, Ji jU & gZL i>£ tty 4/ am better than him (Adam), You created me from Fire and him You created from clay.} [7:12] and 4^ tfil Jlijvty 4 "Do you see this one whom You have honored above me..." [17:62] tili il> JU c j Jlty (Allah) said: "Then leave, for verily, you are an outcast."

435. "And verily, the curse shall be upon you until the Day of Recompense."} 436. [Iblis] said: "O my Lord! Then give me respite until the Day they (the dead) will be resurrected."} 437. Allah said: "Then verily, you are of those reprieved,"} 438. "Until the Day of the time appointed."} The Expulsion of Iblis from Jannah, and His Reprieve until the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us how He issued an unconditional command to Iblis to leave the position he held among the highest of heights. He told him that he was an outcast, i.e., cursed, and that he would be followed by a curse that would hound him until the Day of Resurrection. It was reported that Said bin Jubayr said: "When Allah cursed Iblis, his image into something different from that of the angels, and he made a sound like a bell. Every bell that rings on this earth until the Day of Resurrection is part of that. This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. fr *1 ... ^ * y ^ Si si 61 0142 \$ lit fri yC *2 d j2r lift It 439. [Iblis] said: "O my Lord! Because You misled me, I shall indeed adorn the path of error for them (mankind) on the earth, and I shall mislead them all."} 440. "Except Your chosen (guided) servants among them."} 441 . (Allah) said : "This is the way which will lead straight to Me."} 442. "Certainly, you shall have no authority over My servants, except those of the astray who follow you."} 443. And surely, Hell is the place promised for them all.} 444. It has seven gates, for each of those gates is a class assigned.}

395 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (39-44) (Part-14) The Threat of Iblis to tempt Mankind, and Allah's Promise of Hell for him Allah informed about the rebellion and arrogance of Iblis, in that he said to the Lord: 4 Because You misled me,} i.e., because You misled me and misguided me. 41 shall indeed adorn the path of error for them meaning, for the progeny of Adam. 4dfX1 4 on the earth,} meaning - I will make sin dear to them, and will encourage, provoke and harass them to commit sin. 4 and I shall mislead them all.} meaning - just as You have misled me and have ordained that for me. 4 Except Your chosen, (guided) servants among them.} This is like the Ayah: t / f* v % * •i S' •* , / v «jit 4 "Do you see this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite until the Day of Resurrection, I will surely seize and mislead his offspring, all but a few!"} (17:62). 4 (Alldh) said, i.e., threatening and warning Iblis. 4 This is the way which will lead straight to Me.} means, 'all of you will return to Me, and I will reward or punish you according to your deeds: if they are good then I will reward you, and if they are bad then I will punish you.'

396 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir This is like the Ayah: <a£) 5)^ i Verily, your Lord is ever watchful. (89:14) and i And it is up to Allah to show the right way.} (16:9) i Certainly, you shall have no authority over My servants} meaning, You will have no way to reach those for whom I have decreed guidance.' dicit ^ ^ except those of the astray who follow you.} Ibn Jarir mentioned that Yazid bin Qusayt said: "The

Prophets used to have Masjids outside their cities, and if a Prophet wanted to consult with his Lord about something, he would go out to his place of worship and pray as Allah decreed. Then he would ask Him about whatever was concerning him. Once while a Prophet was in his place of worship, the enemy of Allah - meaning Iblls - came and sat between him and the Qiblah (direction of prayer). The Prophet said, 'I seek refuge with Allah from the accursed Shaytan.' [The enemy of Allah said, 'Do you know who you are seeking refuge from? Here he is!'] The Prophet said, 'I seek refuge with Allah from the accursed Shaytan', and he repeated that three times. Then the enemy of Allah said, 'Tell me about anything in which you will be saved from me.' The Prophet twice said, 'No, you tell me about something in which you can overpower the son of Adam?' Each of them was insisting that the other answer first, then the Prophet said, 'Allah says, Si cr% rp- ^Certainly, you shall have no authority over My servants, except those of the astray whofallow you.'} The enemy of Allah said, '*I heard this before you were even bom.' The Prophet said, 'And Allah says,

p. %\&&p^ u iAnd if an evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan then seek refuge with AllSh. Verily, He is All-Hearing, All-Knowing} (7:200). By Allah, I never sense that you are near but I seek refuge with Allah from you.' The enemy of Allah said, '*You have spoken the truth. In this way you will be saved from me.' The Prophet said, 'Tell me in what ways you overpower the son of Adam.' He said, 'I seize him at times of anger and times of desire. iAnd surely, Hell is the place promisedfor them all.} meaning, Hell is the abode designated for all those who follow Iblls, as Allah says in the Qur'an: <ii j. .* JK ibut those of the sects (Jews, Christians and all the other non- Muslim nations) that reject it (the Qur'an), the Fire will be their promised meeting place.}(1 1:17) The Gates ofHell are Seven Then Allah tells us that Hell has seven gates: ifor each of those gates is a (special) class (of sinners) assigned.} means, for each gate a portion of the followers of IbLTs have been decreed, and they will have no choice in the matter. May Allah save us from that. Each one will enter a gate according to his deeds, and will settle in a level of Hell according to his deeds. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Samurah bin Jundub reported from the Prophet about. * >• rri yC PJ} m At-Tabari 17:105.

399Surah 15. Al-Hiir (45-50) (Part-14 448. No sense offatigue shall touch them, nor shall they be asked to leave it. 449. Declare to My servants that I am truly the Forgiving, the Most Merciful . 450. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment. Description ofthe People ofParadise Since Allah mentioned the condition of the people of Hell, He followed that by mentioning the people of Paradise. He tells us that they will dwell in Gardens and water springs. 4^i 4Enter it in peace^ meaning free of all problems. 4and security.} meaning free from all fear and concern. They will not have any fear of expulsion, nor will they fear that their condition will be disrupted or end. >> /<• . * •# 4And We shall remove any deep feeling of bitternessfrom their breasts. (So they will be like) brothers facing each other on thrones.} Al-Qasim narrated that Abu Umamah said: "The people of Paradise will enter Paradise with whatever enmity is left in their hearts from this world. Then, when they come together, Allah will remove whatever hatred the world has left in their hearts." 1 11 Then he recited: 4And We shall remove any deep feeling of bitternessfrom their breasts.} This is how it was narrated in this report, but Al-Qasim bin 'Abdur-Rahman is weak in his reports from Abu Umamah. However, this is in accord with the report in the Sahih where HI At-Tabari 17:107.

Qatadah says, "Abu Al-Mutawakkil An-Naji told us that Abu Said Al-Khudri told them that the Messenger of Allah $\text{sg said: } 0=? \text{ Y)}^{\wedge} \text{ J}^* \text{ Iff Sjjijjl } (*^{\wedge} \text{ Oif } *P^{**} \text{ J 'il klJlf jvJUii } <^{\wedge} 4^{\wedge} \ll^{\wedge} \text{ Jy-i } "$ The believers will be removed from the Fire, and they will be detained on a bridge between Paradise and Hell. Then judgment will be passed between them concerning any wrong they have committed in this world against one another, until they are cleansed and purified. Then permission will be given to them to enter Paradise."¹¹¹ 4No sense of fatigue shall touch them> meaning no harm or hardship, as was reported in the Sahuhs Njj a. oi tiJi o? 1 Sil jt *Allah' commanded me to tell Khadijah the good news of a jeweled palace in Paradise in which there will be no toil and no fatigue, b*21 (*-* ^ inor shall they (ever) be asked to leave it.\$ As was reported in the Hadlth: .y dl Op t ljjl 1yj>yC, "ji I^>wlj jf dl ! JaI ! J : ^ ^ op ' \yrr> if jp i \Ju\ 1fifra 'ji a tjbi l </f will be said, O dwellers of Paradise! You will be healthy and never fall sick; you will live and never die; you will be young and never grow old ; you will stay here and never leavefr3 Al-Bukhari no. 6535. ^ Path Al-Bari 7 :166 , Muslim 4 :1887 •3| Muslim 4:2182.

402Surah 15. Al-Hijr (51-56) (Part-14) Allah says: Oyu V V* <1 ^Wherein they shall dwell (forever) . They will have no desire to be removed from it.} (18:108) '-« .< x 5£, ; . t ' !A y** J'J ^Declare to My servants, that I am truly the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} meaning, ' O Muhammad, tell My servants that I am the source of mercy and I am the source of punishment.' Similar Ayat to this have already been quoted above, which indicate that we must always be in a state between hope (for Allah's mercy) and fear (of His punishment). n« .jx&jjp Li ^J IS ijJLSi I>li.j jl 'f -J' > * -J' / /> ^ ^ ^ , Jli{p J1^13) ^ ^JIS <jS>iL3i)W[z£jJ I3--0'^ -r v yu jii iljji yui ijtj ji .juu> ^ jjli -*t» ^'r~="3" ^ Jli fgj.jJe ^iu 1^1 Jr? c>; l>-i; (j'j Jli ""^OS^jJl ^3 Vi iS*JI{ 4S;^juji ^51. And tell them about the guests (i.e., the angels) of Ibrahim.} 452. When they entered upon him, and said: "Saldman (peace!)." He said: "Indeed we arefrightened ofyou."}

453. They said: "Do not be afraid! We bring you the good news ofa boy possessing much knowledge and wisdom."} 454. He said: "Do you give me this good news while old age has overtaken me? Ofwhat then is your news about?"} 455. They said: "We give you good news in truth. So do not be of those who despair."} 456. He said: "And who despairs of the mercy of his lord except those who are astray?"} The Guests ofIbrahim and theirGood News ofaSon for Him Allah is saying: Tell them, O Muhammad, about the story of 4the guests ofIbrahim.}' 4they entered upon him, and said: "Saldman (peace!)." He said: "Indeed we arefrightened ofyou."} meaning that they were scared. The reason for their fear has been mentioned previously, which is that they noticed that these guests did not eat of the food that was offered, which was a fattened calf. ij~£ 1 4They said: "Do not be afraid!..."} meaning, do not be scared. 4We bring you the good news of a boy possessing much knowledge and wisdom.} this refers to Ishaq, as was previously mentioned in Surat Hud. Then 4He said} meaning he spoke with wonder and astonishment, asking for confirmation, because he was old and his wife was old:

4Do you give me this good news while old age has overtaken me? Ofwhat then is your news about?} They responded by confirming the good news they had brought, good news after good news: o; iThey said: "We give you good news in truth. So do not be of those who despair."} 457. He said: "What then is the business for which you have come, O messengers?"} 458. They said: "We have been sent to a guilty people."} 459. "(All) except thefamily ofLut, all ofwhom we are to save (from the destruction)."

460. "Except for his wife, of whom We have decreed that she shall be of those who remain behind." } The Reason why the Angels came Allah tells us that after Ibrahim had calmed down from the excitement of this good news, he started to ask them why they had come to him. They said, *dl taj \}* 4 We have been sent to a guilty people. } meaning the people of Lut. They told him that they were going to save the family of Lot from among those people, except for his wife, because she was one of those who were doomed. Thus it was said, *yavs&& •*> l 1 ** "Qaddamd" meaning, "we have determined" is interpreted by the scholars of Tafsir as it has been translated. They say that the angels speak in this form because of their closeness to Allah, a status of which other creatures do not have the honor. See the Tafsir of Af-Tabari

lii- *[yjdj -l3 Sij ^ J £ji»A» jA> jj'i' ilU, 'i \Loijf#;* in of 465. "Then travel for a portion of the night with your family, and you go behind them in the rear, and let no one amongst you look back, but go on to where you are ordered." } 466. And We made this decree known to him that those (sinners) would be rooted out in the early morning. } Lut is ordered to leave with His Family during the Night Allah tells us that His angels ordered Lut to set out after part of the night had passed. They told him to walk behind them, to protect them. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah would walk in the rear of the army on military campaigns, order to help the weak and carry those who had no means transport. 453 *pB-vt %}* i and let no one amongst you look back, } meaning - when you hear the people screaming from their torment, do not turn around to look at them; leave them face whatever punishment and vengeance is coming to them but go on to where you are ordered. } - it is as if they had a guide with them to show them the way. *ijj\ <4'i 4* And We made this decree known to him } meaning - We already told him about that. 4[^] *%&}* i that those (sinners) would be rooted out in the early morning. } meaning in the morning, as in another Ayah. 4 Indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near? } [11:81] to

406 Tafoir Ibn Kathir % *Vi Jtt j-lf #3 if^# 4 -J>: \$£ ju \$t%£Z >^+»"i (^l* 467. And the inhabitants of the city came rejoicing. } 466. [Lilt] said: "Verily, these are my guests, so do not shame me." } 469. "And have Taqwd of Allah, and do not disgrace me." } 470. They said: "Did we not forbid you from entertaining any of the 'Alamin?" } 471. [Lilt] said: "These are my daughters, if you must act (so)." } 472. Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly. } The People of the City arrive upon the Angels, thinking that they are Men Allah tells us about how Lut's people came to him when they found out about his handsome guests, and they came happily rejoicing about them. 4 [Lut] said: "Verily, these are my guests, so do not shame me. And have Taqwd of Allah, and do not disgrace me." } This is what Lot said to them before he knew that his guests were messengers from Allah, as mentioned in Surat Hud, but here (in this Surah), we have already been told that they are messengers from Allah, and this is followed by an account of Lot's people coming and his exchange with them. However, here the conjunction {wa, meaning "and"} does not imply the sequence of events, especially since there is something to indicate that this is not the case. They said answering him, 4 Did we not forbid you from entertaining (or protecting) any of the 'Alamin? } meaning, 'did we not tell you that you should not have anyone

as a guest?' He reminded them about their womenfolk and of what their Lord had created for them in the women permissible sexual relationships. This issue has already been explained and is no need to repeat the discussion here. of this happened while they were still unaware of inevitable calamity and

punishment that was about to befall them the following morning. Hence Allah, may He be exalted, said to Muhammad ﷺ, ^{^J} 4 Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.} Allah swore by the life of His Prophet ﷺ, which is immense honor reflecting his high rank and noble status. ‘Amr bin Malik An-Nakari reported from Abu Al-Jawza’ that Han ‘Abbas said: “Allah has never created or made or formed any soul that is dearer to him than Muhammad ﷺ. I never heard that Allah swore by the life of anyone else. Allah says, ⁱ Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.} meaning, by your life and the length of your stay in this world ⁴ in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.}^ This was reported by Ibn Jarir. Qatadah said: ⁱ in their wild intoxication} “It means - in their misguided state; ^l 4 they were wandering blindly} means - they were playing.”*31 ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: ^{d, * ! *} See the Tafsir of Surah Hud. [2] At-Tabari 17:118. At-Tabari 17:119.

409 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (73-77) (Part-14) down, and stones of baked clay [As-SijjU) raining down upon them. The discussion of As-SijjU in Surah Hud is a sufficient explanation. Allah said: ⁱ Surely, in this are signs for those who see.} meaning that the traces of the destruction of that city are easily visible to any one who ponder about it, whether they look at it with physical eyesight or mental and spiritual insight, as Mujahid said concerning the phrase. ⁱ those who see} he said, “those who have insight and discernment.”*1 It was reported from Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak that it referred to those who look.*2 * Qatadah said: “those who ^{le}im lessons”.*3 ^{' iU&A}} } those who see} therefore the meaning is “those who ponder”. The City of Sodom on the Highroad ⁴ And verily, they were right on the highroad.} meaning that the city of Sodom, which was physically and spiritually turned upside down, and pelted with stones until it became a foul smelling lake (the Dead Sea), is on a route that is easily accessible until the present day. This is like the Ayah, ⁴ Verily, you pass by them in the morning, and at night. Will you not then reflect?} (37:137-138). 111 At-Tabari 17:120. ' At-Tabari 17:121. ' At-Tabari 17:121.

4 ⁱ ff illi j ⁱ Surely, there is indeed a sign in that for the believers.) meaning, ‘All that We did to the people of Lut, from the destruction and the vengeance, to how We saved Lut and his family, these are clear signs to those who believe in Allah and His Messengers.’ 478. And the Dwellers of Al-Aykah, were also wrongdoers.) 479. So, We took vengeance on them. They are both on an open route, plain to see.) The Destruction of the Dwellers of Al-Aykah, the People of Shu'ayb The Dwellers of Al-Aykah, were the people of Shu'ayb. Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah and others said that Al-Aykah refers to intertwined trees ^{J *} Their evil doing included associating partners with Allah (Shirky, banditry and cheating in weights and measures. Allah punished them with the Sayhah (the awful cry or torment), the earthquake, and the torment of the Day of Shadow.¹²¹ They lived near the people of Lut, but at a later time, and the people of Lut were known to them, which is why Allah says, ⁱ d 00 ⁱ They are both on an open route, plain to see.) Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others said, “a visible route.”¹³¹ This is why, when Shu'ayb warned his people, he said to them, ^{t^==^t •j'j} f ⁱ And the people of Lut are not far off from you!) [1 1:89] I ^{Jt £0} At-Tabari 17:125. [2] At-Tabari 17:125.

ⁱ f £ ^{ti} P C /. g jcu * 4 fuf' «io 480. And verily, the Dwellers of Al-Hijr denied the Messengers.> 481 . And We gave them Our signs, but they were averse to them.} 482. And they used to hew out dwellings from the mountains, (feeling) secure.} 483 . But the Sayhah (torment - awful cry) overtook them in the early morning.} And all that they used to earn availed them not.} The Destruction of the

Dwellers of Al-Hijr, Who are the People called Thamud The Dwellers of the Al-Hijr were the people of Thamud who rejected their Prophet, Salih. Whoever denies even one Messenger, then he has disbelieved in all of the Messengers, thus they are described as rejecting "the Messengers". Allah tells us that he (Salih) brought them signs to prove that what he was telling them was true, such as the she-camel which Allah created for them out of a solid rock in response to the supplication of Salih. This she-camel was grazing on their lands, and the people and the camel took water on alternate days that were well-known. When they rebelled and killed it, he said to them, Ji- 4 "Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. This is a promise which will not be belied." (1 1:65] Allah said: its®\$£» £2 &;} 4 And as for Thamud, We showed them and made the path of truth clear but they preferred blindness to guidance.} [41:17] Allah tells us that, JLi f

4 And they used to hew out dwellings from the mountains, (feeling) secure.} meaning, they were without fear and they had no real need for those houses; it was merely a form of extravagance and work without a purpose. This could be seen from their work in the houses in the Al-Hijr through which the Messenger of Allah jg passed on his way to Tabuk. He covered his head and urged his camel to go faster, saying to his Companions: ty M^ j^i (tf iJJ.i v» p At jf "Do not enter the dwellings of those who were punished unless you are weeping, and if you do not weep then make yourself weep out offear that perhaps what struck them may also strike yoM-B 1 ' 4 But the Sayhah (torment - awful cry) overtook them in the early morning.} meaning in the morning of the fourth day. ZfSb IX \S 4 And all that they used to earn availed them not.} meaning all of the benefits that they used to gain from their crops and fruits, and the water which they did not want to share with the she-camel that they killed so that it would not reduce their share of the water - all of that wealth would not protect them or help them when the command of their Lord came to pass. CJ4; Cy u>jì\ luU- Iaj} 485. And We did not create the heavens and the earth and all that is between them except with the truth, and the Hour is surely coming, so overlook their faults with gracious forgiveness.} 486. Verily, your Lord is the Knowing Creator.} IM Ahmad 2 :91

The World has been created for some Purpose, then the Hour will come Allah says, ^ Vi Cj i {And We did not create the heavens and the earth and all that is between them except with the truth, and the Hour is surely coming}, i.e., with justice to - Q \& 'S {requite those who do evil with that which they have done [53:31] Allah says, Si 'jf*' U& S-j* \}/& iwM S" «stti L^> tA>V*j sU' tili- {And We did not create the heaven and the earth, and all that is between them without purpose! That is what those who disbelieve think! Then let those who disbelieve be warned of the Fire!}(38:27) v Jtff 30 if v t4[pS {"Did you think that We created you in play, and that you would not be brought back to Us?" So exalted be Allah, the Truth, the King, none has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of the Honored 7? irone/^ (23:115-116). Then Allah informed His Prophet jg about the Hour, and that it will be the faults of the idolators when they insult him and reject the Message that he brings to them. This is like thi Ayah, / Jib,* > I*, 'f frV Or-» pi- J«j fr {So him away from them, and say: "Saldm (Peace!)." But , they will come to know} (43:89). i Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: "This was before fighting was prescribed". It is as they said, because this Surah was revealed in Makkah and fighting was prescribed after the Hijrah

iVerily, your lord is the Knowing Creator)!15:86). This is a confirmation of the Day of Resurrection and that Allah, may He be exalted, is able to bring the Hour to pass. He is the Creator and nothing is beyond Him. He is the Knowing, Who knows what has been dispersed from people's bodies and scattered throughout the regions of the earth, as He says: o&' j*j ck .*4hi J ..ju 'i&z g % jj; j in,4 Tii ,:ji] U[jjiy <Is not He, Who created the heavens and the earth able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the Knowing, Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is! So glorified and exalted is He above all that they associate with Him, and in whose Hands is the dominion of all things, and to Him you shall return.>(36:81-83). 4,87. And indeed, We have bestowed upon you seven of the MathaniP1 and the Grand Qur'an .) 488. Look not with your eyes ambitiously at what We have given to certain classes of them, nor grieve over them. And lower your wings to the believers.) A Reminder of the Blessing of the Qur'an and the Command to focus on its Message Allah is saying to His Prophet Since We have given you the Grand Qur'an, then do not look at this world and its attractions, or the transient delights that we have given to its people in order to test them. Do not envy what they have in this world, and do not upset yourself with regret for their m Ma.th6.nimeans "often recited

rejection ofyou and their opposition to your religion. iAttd lower your wings to the believers who follow you} (26:215) meaning - be gentle with them, like the Ayah, Jai> iVerily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is anxious for you, for the believers - he is full of pity, kind and merciful}(9:28). There were some differences among the scholars over the meaning of "seven of the Mathani". Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Umar, Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and others said that they are the seven long (Surahs), meaning Al-Baqarah, Al- 'Imran, An-Nisa', Al-Ma'idah, Al-An'am, Al-A'raf and Yunus. There are texts to this effect reported from Ibn 'Abbas and Said bin Jubayr. Said said: "In them, Allah explains the obligations, the Hudud (legal limits), stories and rulings." Ibn 'Abbas said, "He explains the parables, stories and lessons."111 The second opinion is that they (the seven of the Mathani) are Al-Fatihah, which is composed of seven Ayat. This was reported from 'Ali, Umar, Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn 'Abbas. Ibn 'Abbas said: "The Bismillah,' is completing seven Ayah, which Allah has given exclusively to you (Muslims)."*3 * This is also the opinion of Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, 'Abdullah bin Umayr, Ibn Abi Mulaykah, Shahr bin Hawshab, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Mujahid.*4 ' Al-Bukhari, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded two Hadlths on this topic. (The first) was recorded from Abu Said bin Al-Mu'alla, who said: "The Prophet sfe passed by me while I 1,1 At-Jabari 17:130-132. That is the statement "BismUldhir-Rahmanir-Rahim" , which means, "In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Mercifu." Accordingly, the Fatihah comprises seven Ayat. * At-Tabari 17:133. > At-Jabari 17 : 135.

416 Tafslr Ibn Kathir was praying. He called out for me but I did not come until I finished my prayer. Then I came to him, and He asked, jl iLLu La "What stopped you from coming to me?* I said, T was praying'. He said, Jii ji; "'Did not Allah say k iEC *if \$s> iO you who believe! Answer Allah (by obeying Him) and (His) Messenger when he calls you . . ?> [8:24] "4*—Jl IjA Ej>-\ o! Jj Jjj (jiii-\ viLili-f 'if "Shall I not teach you the most magnificent Surah before 1 leave the Masjid?# Then the Prophet went to leave the Masjid, and I reminded him, so he said, ?dli)' v_y 4jl 4 'Al-Hamdu Lillahi Rabbit-'Alamin [All praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord ofall that exists]}{1:2). jlijl £ili^ *This is

the seven of the Mathani and the Qur'an which I have been given.*" (The second Hadith) was reported from Abu Hurayrah who said that the Messenger of Allah[^] said: jTjiilj «Umm Al-Qur'an (the Mother or the Essence of the Qur'an,) is the seven Mathani, and the Grand Qur'an. n 1 * 1 This means that Al-Fatihah is the seven Mathani and the Grand Qur'an, but this does not contradict the statement that the seven Mathani are the seven long Surahs, because they also share these attributes, as does the whole Qur'an. As Allah m Path Al-Bari 8 :232

417Sural: 15. Al-Hiir (89-93) (Part-14 says, a% iAllah has sent down the best statement, a Book (this Qur'an), its parts resembling each oilier in goodness and truth, oft- recited) (39:23). So it is oft-recited in one way, and its parts resemble one another in another way, and this is also the Grand Qur'an. 4J44 * ££ C d[V& 1) iLook not with your eyes ambitiously at what We have given to certain classes ofthan) [20:131] meaning, be content with the Grand Qur'an that Allah has given to you, and do not long for the luxuries and transient delights that they have. iLook not with your eyes ambitiously) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "He [in this Ayah forbade a man to wish for what his companion has." iat what We have given to certain classes ofthem,) Mujahid said: "This refers to the rich."*21 j'vji* <> £0 X3T jffj\ bl fa) 489. And say (O Muhammad): "I am indeed a plain wamer.") 490. As We have sent down on the Muqtasimin (conspiring confederates,) 491 . Who have made the Qur'an into parts.) 492. So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of than to account.) 493 . For all that they used to do.) Al-Tabari 17:141. Al-Tabari 17:141.

418 Tafsir Ibri Kathir The Messenger jg is a Plain Warner Allah commanded His Prophet jg to tell the people: 41 am indeed a plain zvamer} coming to warn the people of a severe punishment that they will suffer if they reject him, as happened to those nations before them who disbelieved in their Messengers, upon whom Allah sent His punishment and vengeance. In the two Sahihs it is reported from Abu Musa that the Prophet jg said: cjtj yi ! : JUi \ 4i -di I U AAjS ^jA apQati jjjljl Ul c j*4~? OjjS'j ^ ja *• \j2iajvj At O-i*- La if J~* jv^Lali If ii ^ 4'^J (jjLi*- Jlij «77i(? parable of myself and that with which Allah has sent me is that of a man who came to his people and said, 'O people! I have seen the [invading] army with my own eyes, and I am a naked warmer, so escape, escape!' Some of his people obeyed him and set out at nightfall, setting offat a slow pace and managing to escape. Others did not believe him and stayed where they were until the next morning when the [invading] army overtook them and destroyed them, wiping them out. This is the parable of the one who obeys me and follows what I have brought, and the example of the one who disobeys me and rejects the truth that I have brought Explanation of "Al-Muqtasimin" 4the Muqtasimm} refers to those who had made a pact to oppose, deny, and insult the Prophets. Similarly, Allah tells us about the people of Salih: ^ JcOjj ait ts yu^ I 1 * FathAl-Bari 13:264, Muslim 4:1788.

iThey said, "Swear to one another [Taqdsamu] by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household [27:49] i.e., they plotted to kill him at night. Mujahid said "Taqdsamu means they swore an oath." 4And they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up one who dies^(16:38). ui \yjs=£ 4(11 will be said): "Did you not before swear that you would not leave (the worldfor the Hereafter)) (14:44) <Are they those, of whom you swore that Allah would never show them mercy}[7:49j It is as if they took an oath for every single thing that they denied in this world, so they are called the Muqtasimin. 4Who have made the Qur'an into parts.} meaning, they have split up

the Books that were revealed to them, believing in parts of them and rejecting parts of them. Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4‘-^~tt 4Who have made the Qur’an into parts.} “They are the People of the Book, who divided the Book into parts, believing in some of it, and rejecting some of it.”¹¹¹ Some have said that Al-Mutaqasimin refers to the Quraysh, that the Qur’an means this Qur’an [as opposed to the Scriptures of the People of the Book], and that “made it into pails referred to what ‘Ata’ said that some of them said that he (the Prophet sg) was a sorcerer, some said he was crazy, or a soothsayer. These various allegations were the parts. This Fath Al-B&ri 8 :233

420 Tafsir Ibn Kathir opinion was also reported from Ad-Dahhak and others. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that Al- Walid bin Al-Mughlah - holding a noble position among the people - rallied a group of Quraysh behind him when Al- Mawsim (the time for pilgrims to meet in Makkah for Hajj) had come. He said to them, “O people of Quraysh! The time of Al- Mawsim has come, and delegations of Arabs will come to you during this time. They will have heard some things about this companion of yours (meaning the Prophet jg), so agree on one opinion, let there be no contradicting or denials of each other’s sayings”. They said, “And you, O Abu ‘Abd Shams, give us an opinion and we will say that.” He said, “No, you make the suggestions and I will listen.” They said, “We say he is a soothsayer.” He said, “He is not a soothsayer.” They said, “We say he is crazy.” He said, “He is not crazy.” They said, “We say he is a poet.” He said, “He is not a poet.” They said, “We say he is a sorcerer.” He said, “He is not a sorcerer.” They said, “So what should we say?” He said, “By Allah, what he says is as palatable (to the average person) as something sweet, so you cannot say anything against it without it being obviously false. Therefore the most appropriate thing you can say is that he is a sorcerer.” So they left having agreed upon that, and Allah revealed concerning them: iWho have made the Qur’an into parts> meaning, of different types, and 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do> Those were the group who said that about the Messenger of Allah jg.”* 11 iSo, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.\$ 111 Sirah Ibn Hisham, 1 :288. This narration is not authentic due to one of the narrators being unknown

421 Surah 15. Al-Hiir (94-99) (Part-14) Abu Ja’far reported from Ar-Rabl‘ that Abu Al-‘Aliyah said, “All the people will be asked about two things on the Day of Resurrection: what they used to worship, and what their response was to the Messengers.”*¹¹ ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, ds;;& 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} then he said: A *M 1 r asos&s nv - s’s”” ‘ -’.r • >’****” •+ .’.H ‘ l”” A»iJuujiv’y >. 0 3&JLfrtj wcm\m jf ‘i.P’ot <sCgiJij>»^ <So on that Day no question will be asked of man or jinn as to his sin (55:39). He said, “They will not be asked, T>id you do such and such?’ Because Allah knows better than they do about that. But He will say, *Why did you do such and such?’”*²¹ 494. Therefore openly proclaim what you have been 111 At-Tabari 17:150. At-Tabari 17:150.

422 Tahir Ibt Kathir commanded, and turn away from the idolators.> 495. Truly, We will suffice you against the mockers,) 496. Who make another god along with Allah; but they will come to know .fr 497. Indeed, We know that your breast becomes tight because of what they say.) 498. So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those who prostrate themselves (to Him).) 499. And worship your Lord until the certainty (i.e. death) comes to you.) The Command to proclaim the Truth openly Allah

commanded His Messenger to convey what He sent him with, to proclaim and spread the Message, which means confronting the idolators with it. Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah, 4% U,££) 4Therefore openly proclaim that what you have been commanded,) means, “Go ahead with it.”¹¹¹ According to another report it means, “Therefore proclaim that which you commanded.” Mujahid said, “It is reciting the Qur’an aloud during prayer.”¹²¹ Abu Tjbydah reported that ‘Abdullah bin MasTkd said, “The Prophet jg was still practicing and preaching Islam secretly until this Ayah was revealed: 4s\$W£Z) 4Therefore openly proclaim that which you are commanded) then he and his Companions came out into the open.”³¹ 111 At-Tabari 17:151. 121 At-Tabari 17:151. 131 At-Tabari 17:152.

423Surah 15. Al-Hijr (94-99) (Part-14) TheCommand to turnaway from the Idolators, and the Guarantee ofProtection against the Mockers Allah’s statement, iand turn away from idolators. Truly, We will suffice you against the mockers.) meaning - convey that which has been revealed to you by your Lord, and do not pay attention to the idolators who want to turn you away from the signs of Allah. t-L iA* J) iThey wish that you should compromise for them, so that they would compromisefar you) (68:9). Do not fear them because Allah will suffice you against them, and He will protect you from them. This is like the Ayah: .<•<- i// . - aJL-j ..l.iil; li 40 Messenger! Proclaim that which has been revealed to you from your Lord. And if you do not do it, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind.) [5:67] Muhammad bin Ishaq said: “The great ones of the mockers were five people, who were elders and noblemen among their people. From Banl Asad bin ‘Abd Al-TJzza bin Qusayy there was Al-Aswad bin Al-Muttalib Abu Zam’ah. According to what I heard, the Messenger of Allah (s^) had supplicated against him because of the pain and mockery he had suffered at his hands. He sg| had said, aojJJ ^S-^ 1 3 «0 Allah, make him blind and take (the life of) his son. From Banl Zahrah there was Al-Aswad bin ‘Abd Yaghuth bin Wahb bin ‘Abd Manaf bin Zahrah. From Banl Makhzum there was Al-Walld bin Al-Mughlrah bin ‘Abdullah bin “Umar bin Makhzum. From Banl Sahm bin ‘Amr bin Husays bin Ka*b bin

425Surah 15. Al-Hiir (94-99) (Part-14 to know.) This is a strong warning and grave threat against those who have other deities along with Allah.

Encouragement to bear Difficulties, and the Command

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2965–2967]

to glorify and worship Allah until Death Allah said, Si <4’-> 4*^5 Cr** a*. 4Indeed We know that your breast becomes tight because of what they say. So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those wlv prostrate themselves (to Him).} meaning “We know, O Muhammad, that you are distressed by their insults towards you, but do not let that weaken your resolve or cause you to give up conveying the Message of Allah. Put your trust in Him, for He will suffice you and will support you against them. Keep yourself busy with remembering Allah, praising Him, glorifying Him, and worshipping Him (which means Salah, or prayer)’ Hence Allah says: S;& -PiQpb }So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those who prostrate themselves (to Him)} Imam Ahmad reported from Nu’aym bin Hammar that he heard the Messenger of Allah say: u’jA iusl o «Allah said, “O son ofAdam! It is not too difficult for you to perform four Rak’dt at the beginning of the day, (and ifyou do them,) I will take care ofyou until

the end of it."*111 iJi JDt£ XL\j} iAnd worship your Lord until the certainty comes to you} (15:99). Al-Bukhari said: "Salim said, '(This means) death.'"12 ' This Ahmad 5:286. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:235.

=±2 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Salim is Salim bin 'Abdullah bin 'Umar. Ibn Jarir also recorded from Salim bin 'Abdullah, jLj JLtt,} iAnd worship your Lord until the Yaqm comes to you.} He said, "Death."111 It is reported in the Sahih from Umm Al- 'Ala'- one of the women of the Ansar - that when the Messenger of Allah ^ entered upon 'Uthman bin Maz*un after he had died, Umm Al-'Ala' said, "May the mercy of Allah be upon you, Abu As-Sa'ib. My testimony over you is that Allah has honored you."The Messenger ofAllah^ said, 2>i !>i iiiji; How do you know that Allah has honored him? I said, "May my father and mother be sacrificed for you, Messenger of Allah! If not him, then who else?" He said, djliJl <1 ' Jlii y* lif «As far as he is concerned, the death has come to him, and I hopefor goodfor him .»121 This is evidence that the meaning of this Ayah, iAnd worship your Lord until the certainty comes to you.} is that acts of worship, such as prayer and the like, are obligatory on man so long as his mind is sound, so he should pray according to his best ability. It was reported in Sahih Al-Bukhari from 'Imran bin Husayn jfe that the Messenger ofAllah^ said: p 0^ ' 1-LfrUi jU jji i Uili oPray standing, and if you cannot, then sitting, and if you cannot, then on your side.*131 From this we may understand that it is a mistake to interpret Yaqui (the certainty) as Ma'rifah ("spiritual knowing") At-Jabari 17:160. FathAl-Bdri 3:137. FathAl-Bdri 2:684.

427Surah 15. Al-Hijr (94-99) (Part-14) as some of the Sufis do. According to them, when one of them attains the level of Ma'rifah, they consider him to be free of these obligations. This is disbelief, misguidance and ignorance. The Prophets - peace be upon them - and their companions, were the most knowledgeable of people about Allah, about His rights. His attributes, and the glorification that He deserves. But at the same time, they were the people who worshipped Him the most, continuing in good deeds until the time they died. Therefore, what is meant by Vdqm here is death, as we have stated above. To Allah be praise and thanks. Praise be to Allah for His guidance. It is to Him that we turn for help and it is in Him that we put our trust. He is the One Whom we ask to help us to reach the best of circumstances, for He is the Most Generous and Kind. This is the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hijr. Praise be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.

Surah 16: An-Nahl

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 5, 6

PDF pages: 2968–3089

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2968]

Opening 428 Tafsir Von Kathir The Tafsir of Surat An-Nahl (Chapter - 16) Which was revealed in Makkah \$ *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. * **\$3 41. The Event ordained by Allah has indeed come, so do not seek to hasten it. Glorified and Exalted be He above all that they associate as partners with Him .}

Warning about the approach of the Hour

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2968–3000]

Allah is informing about the approach of the Hour in the past tense [in Arabic] in order to confirm that it will undoubtedly come to pass. This is like the following Ayat, in which the verbs appear in the past tense in Arabic: 4SY ' * .. . i', ' iMankind's reckoning has drawn near them, while they turn away in heedlessness.^[21:1] 4The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft.} [54:1] \$} 4so do not seek to hasten it.} means, what was far is now near, so do not try to rush it. As Allah said, - ^ w •* „, 4 ft9? u\j *— 4And they ask you to listen the torment (for them), and had it not been for a term appointed, the torment would certainly have

come to them. And surely, it will come upon them suddenly while they are unaware! They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily! Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers (29:53-54). Ibn Abi Hatim reported from TjQbah bin 'Amir that the Messenger of Allah jg said: Jly ui JI <jl>w apIzJI xp JU jJS !>£m# t; :i« 3e: ^ tuui j u 'j» ^4Wj : >Jyd If* p4M 'r**- j jLl t j4AJ p < "«; <J_>V <il >1 Jt U "Wfien the Hour approaches, a black cloud resembling a shield will emerge upon front the west. It will continue rising in the sky, then a voice will call out, 'O mankind!' The people will say to one another, 'Did you hear that?' Some will say, 'yes', but others toil! doubt it. Then a second call will come, 'O mankind!' The people will say to one another, 'Did you hear that?' And they will say, 'Yes.' Then a third call will come, 'O mankind!' The Event ordained by Allah has indeed come, so do not seek to hasten if The Messenger of Allah sg said: f\ jjj i Ijbi C\jjh, l«j jty -...) j!\ tj j t oJLj ^ . » 1 ^ ~ Ijbl L«J AI3U J\ kjjJ fc Ijji It..* 4J Uj ijAo .l — (Jb «Bi/ the One in Whose Hand is my soul, two men will spread out a cloth, but will never refold it; a man will prepare his trough, but will never water his animals from it; and a man will milk his camel, but will never drink the milk." Then he said, "The people will be distracted."^ Then Allah tells us that He is free from their allegations of partners to their worship of idols, and making equals for Him. Glorified and exalted be He far above that. These are the people who deny the Hour, so He says: 111 Al-HSkim 4 :539

iAffA Hi #*;^)^Glorified and Exalted be He above all that they associate as partners with Him.) \$ ^ VA J »jCs &•*&&& it i2. He sends down the angels with the Ruh (revelation) ofHis command to those servants of His whom He wills (saying): "Warn mankind that none has the right to be worshipped but I, so have Taqwa ofMe.") Allah sends Whomever He wills with the Message of Tawhdt i&A &> iHe sends down the angels with the Ruh) refers to the revelation. This is like theAyah by in.A iAnd thus We have sent to you a Rfth (revelation) by Our command. You knew not what is the Book, nor what is the faith. But We have made it a light by which We guide whomever We will among Our servants.) (43:52) in 4S»*£» 4to those servants of His whom He wills) meaning the Prophets, as Allah says: iAllah best knows where to place His Message.) [6:124] iAllah chooses Messengers from angels and from men.) (22:751

4He sends the Ruh (revelation) by His command to whoever among His servants He wills to, that he may warn of the Day of Meeting. The Day when they will (all) come out, nothing about them will be hidden from Allah. Whose is the kingdom this Day?: It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!} (40:15-16) i(saying) : "Warn..."} meaning that they should alert them. ithat none has the right to be worshipped but I, so have Taqwd ofMe.} means, "fear My punishment, if you go against My commands and worship anything other than Me.' j < >- ->r i » 43. He has created the heavens and the earth with truth. High is He, Exalted above all that they associate as partners with Him.} 44. He has created man from a NutfahJ then behold, this same (man) becomes an open opponent.} Allah is the One Who has created the Heavens, the Earth, andMan Allah tells us about His creation of the upper realm, which is the heavens, and the lower realm, which is the earth, and everything in them. They have been created for a true purpose, not in vain, so that 4#^£3 hk £t \jd -S 4He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done (i.e. punish them in Hell), and reward those who do good, Drop of sperm.

with what is best (i.e. Paradise).} [53:31] Then He declares Himself to be above the Shirk of those whoworship others besides Him. He is independent of His creation, alone with no partner or associate. For this reason He deserves to be worshipped Alone, without partners. Then Hementions how man has been created from a Nutfah, i.e., something that is insignificant, weak and has no value - but when man becomes independent and is able to fend for himself - then he begins to dispute with his Lord, may He be exalted, and disbelieves in Him and fights His Messengers. Butman was created to be a servant, not an opponent, as Allah says: S<>->> & jjuff Sj %} iAnd it is He Who has created manfrom water, and gave him descendants, and made Him kindred by marriage, and your Lord is capable (of all things). And they worship besides Allah, that which can neither profit them nor harm them; and the disbeliever is ever a helper (of Shaytdn) against his Lord (25:54-55). And; & 13 y \$ ijSL jk) fj-* Jj^ hlil ZsJii Ji Oi iSSSL i3 y *\$} 6 (fy y Jli faii- iDoes not man see that We have created himfrom Nutfah. Yet, behold he stands as an open opponent. And he putsforthfor Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them the first time! And He is the knower of every creature!"} (36:77- Imam Ahmad and Ibn Majah reported that Busr bin Jahhash said: "The Messenger of Allah spat in his palm, then he said,

^ «* TM ^ JI i? :> il j*^s=6j2 Jri . - .y. \ ^j- .t r> -j • # 'jjf - •;, > ,> JI- j* ^a!> ^LA-LO «JAZjy~* IS] V 0AS JI:s>; ^^ ' •-x x - » x , ' # X *•• O.<>>* i JU»j •2Ju- : dii f ^iiAii oiL; iii Ji jlJf ijjLjali uAllah, may

He be exalted, says : “O son of Adam, how could you be more powerful than I when I have created you from something like this, and when I have fashioned you perfectly and made you complete, you walk wearing your tzvo garments and the earth makes a sound (beneath your feet). You collect money but do not give anything to anyone, then when the soul of a dying person reaches the throat, you say, 'I want to give in charity', but it is too late for clarity.” * 1 Lfj ^3j ^j, L£=»fe L+ijj *«-»j l+j ^2==d l+i- <f^J •^4 07*^" t*-ri tSr< yf^ j&tcil J I cruj Likji ji\ f/j^ ^-gj-kriy* aJIL-ii 45 . And the cattle, He has created them for you ; in them there is warmth (warm clothing), and numerous benefits, and you eat from them.} i6. And there is beauty in them for you, when you bring them Ahmad 2 :410 , Ibn Majah 2 :903

animals for all kinds of purposes, for riding and for carrying loads, as Allah says: 4/i 4And verily, there is indeed a lesson for you in the An'am (cattle). We give you to drink (milk) of that which is in their bellies. And there are numerous (other) benefits in them for you. Of them you eat, and on them and on ships you are carried.) (23:21-22) t&KZapS pxp S «st> & pt j CC {£LISU 4Allah, it is He Who has made cattle for you, so that some you may ride, and some you may eat. And you find (many other) benefits in them; you may reach by their means a desire that is in your breasts (i.e. carry your goods, loads), and on them and on ships you are carried. And He shows you His Ayat. Which, then of the Ayat of Allah do you deny?) (40:79-81). Thus here Allah says, after enumerating these blessings, 4Uf>A3 ps dtf 4Truly, your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful.) meaning, your Lord is the One Who has subjugated the An'am (cattle) to you. This is like the Ayat: 'Pf L&f iLjbt c.U c- lli liL. tl ff) 4Do they not see, that of what Our Hands have created, We created the An'am (cattle) for them, so that they may own them, and We subdued them so that they may ride some and they may eat some.>(36:71-72). pj iLi 1{\$& ji .p> jc j3 j£j)

4And He made mounts for you out of ships and cattle. In order that you may ride on their backs, and may then remember the favor of your Lord when you mount upon them, and say: "Glory be to the One Who subjected this to us, and we could never have it (by our efforts). And verily, to Our Lord we indeed are to return!"} (43:12-14) Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4J} l+i p£=£} 4In them there is warmth refers to clothing; iand numerous benefits} refers to the ways in which they derive the benefits of food and drink from them.” 48. And (He has created) horses, mules and donkeys for you to ride, and as an adornment. And He creates (other) things of which you have no knowledge.} This refers to another category of animals that Allah has created as a blessing for His servants; horses, mules and donkeys, all of which He made for riding and adornment. This is the main purpose for which these animals were created. It was reported in the Two Sahls that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said: “The Messenger of Allah jg forbade us to eat the meat of domestic donkeys, but he allowed us to eat the meat of horses.”*21 Imam Ahmad and Abu Dawud reported with two chains of narration, each of which meet the conditions of Muslim, that Jabir said: “On the day of Khaybar we slaughtered horses, mules and donkeys. The Messenger of Allah sg forbade us from eating the mules and donkeys, but he did not forbid us from eating the horses.”*3 According to Sahih Muslim, Asma’ bint Abi Bakr (may Allah be pleased with them both) said: “At the time of the Messenger ** At-Jabari 17:168. *21 Fath Al-Bari 9 :570 , Muslim 3 :1541 ' Ahmad 3:356,362, Abu Dawud 4:149, 151.

437Surah 16. An-Nahl (9) (Part-14) of Allah we slaughtered a horse and ate it when we were in Al-Madinah.”* 11 4 jij L+1*J 4J)> jc-j^ 49. And it is up to Allah to show the right way. But there are ways

that stray. And had He willed, He would have guided you all.} Explanation of the Different Religious Paths When Allah mentioned the animals which may be used for the purpose of physical journeys, He also referred to the moral, religious routes that people may follow. Often in the Qur'an there is a shift from physical or tangible things to beneficial spiritual and religious matters, as when Allah says, j'jrt ji. } iAnd take a provision (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is Taqwa (piety, righteousness).} [2:197] And, 40 Children of Adam! We have granted clothing for you to cover yourselves, as well as for adornment; but the raiment of righteousness, that is better.} [7:26] Since Allah mentioned cattle and other such animals in this Surah, all of which are ridden or can be used in any way necessary, carrying people's necessities for them to distant places and on difficult journeys - then He mentions the ways which people follow to try to reach Him, and explains that the right way is the one that does reach Him. He says: 4^£2i Jej} iAnd it is up to Allah to show the right way.} This is like the Ayat, cA lAr5 •Ar'^ • 'it. \$j} iAnd verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and do not m Muslim 3 : 1541

4If your Lord had willed, then all who are in the earth would have believed.} (10:99) Kijj j»y J* V) l>*Q* jft lily ili 4 owrl oVIV iLK"" ol 4A«d if your Lord had so willed, He could surely, have made humanity one Ummah, but they will not stop disagreeing. Except those for whom your Lord has granted mercy. And it is for this that He did create them; and the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (i.e. His saying) : "Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."} (11:118-119). iiSAim ja k& ft t'A 'ft* 4 <a> Cftft fxfi + ft 420. He it is Who sends water down from the sky; from it you drink and from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.} 422. With it He causes crops to grow for you, the olives, the date palms, the grapes, and every kind of fruit. Verily, in this there is indeed an evident proof and a manifest sign for people who give thought.} The Blessings of Rain, and explaining how it is one of the Signs When Allah mentions the blessings of cattle and other animals that He has granted mankind, He then mentions how He has blessed them by sending rain down from the sky above, which has been fulfilling the needs and bringing joy to people and their cattle. Allah says: 4£ £i j3> ifrom it you drink} meaning, He made it fresh and pure so that they can drink it, not salty and undrinkable. iand from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.}

III At-Tabari 17:178.

441 Surah 16. An-Nahl (12-13) (Part-14) Signs in the Subjection of Night and Day, the Sun and the Moon, and in that which grows on Earth Allah mentions the mighty signs and immense blessings to be found in His subjection of night and day, which follow one another; the sun and moon, which revolve; the stars, both fixed and moving through the skies, offering light by which people may find their way in the darkness. Each of (these heavenly bodies) travels in its own orbit, which Allah has ordained for it, and travels in the manner prescribed for it, without deviating in any way. All of them are under His subjugation, His control and His decree, as Allah says: JiV'j jSi a J£\$c 34 yJei' ii' Qfj ^Indeed, your Lord is Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth in Six Days, and then He rose (Istawa) over the Throne. He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars (all) subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} (7:54) Thus Allah says; iStirely, in this are proofs for people who understand . meaning, they are indications of His immense power and might, for those who think about

Allah and understand His signs. ft 4And whatsoever He has created of varying colors on the earth for you.} When Allah points out the features of the skies, He also points out the wondrous things that He has created on earth, the variety of its animals, minerals, plants and inanimate features, all having different colors and shapes, benefits and qualities. 4a. *-\$

4Verily, in this is a sign for people who reflect. meaning (those who remember) the blessings of Allah and give thanks to Him for them. 424. And He it is Who subjected the sea (to you), that you may eat from the fresh tender meat, and that you bring forth out of it ornaments to wear. And you see the ships plowing through it, that you may seek from His bounty and that you may perhaps be grateful . \$ 415. And He has driven firm standing mountains into the earth, lest it should shake with you; and rivers and roads, that you may guide yourselves. 416. And (by the) landmarks; and by the stars, they guide themselves. 417. Is then He Who creates the same as one who creates, not? Will you not then reflect? \$ 418. And if you would try to count the favors of Allah, you would never be able to count them. Truly, Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful Signs in the Oceans, Mountains, Rivers, Roads and Stars Allah tells us how He has subjected the seas, with their waves lapping the shores, and how He blesses His servants by subjecting the seas for them so that they may travel on them, and by putting fish and whales in them, by making their flesh permissible to eat - whether they are caught alive or dead - at all times, including when people are in a state of Ihram. He has created pearls and precious jewels in the oceans, and made it easy for His servants to recover ornaments that they can wear from the ocean floor. He made the sea such that it carries the ships which plow through it. He is the One Who taught mankind to make ships, which is the inheritance of

443 Surah 16. An-Nahl (14-18) (Part-14) their forefather Nuh. He was the first one to travel by ship, he was taught how to make them, then people took this knowledge from him and passed it down from generation to generation through the centuries, so that they could travel from country to country and from place to place, bringing goods from here to there and from there to here. Thus Allah says: i that you may seek from His bounty and that you may perhaps be grateful.} - for His bounty and blessings. Then Allah mentions the earth and how He placed in it mountains standing firm, which make it stable and keep it from shaking in such a manner that the creatures dwelling on it would not be able to live. Hence Allah says, i And the mountains He has fixed firmly.} (79:32). i and rivers and roads} meaning He has made rivers which flow from one place to another, bringing provision for His servants. The rivers arise in one place, and bring provision to people living in another place. They flow through lands and fields and wildernesses, through mountains and hills, until they reach the land whose people they are meant to benefit. They meander across the land, left and right, north and south, east and west - rivers great and small - flowing sometimes and ceasing sometimes, flowing from their sources to the places where the water gathers, flowing rapidly or moving slowly, as decreed by Allah. There is no god besides Him and no Lord except Him. He also made roads or routes along which people travel from one land or city to another, and He even made gaps in the mountains so that there would be routes between them, as He says: 4And We placed broad highways for them to pass through.} (21:31]

4And landmarks meaning, signs like great mountains and small hills, and so on, things that land and sea travelers use to find their way if they get lost. •> •‘Sif 'V 4^^-r. (« i and by the stars (during the night), they (mankind) guide themselves.} meaning, in the darkness of the night. This was the opinion of Ibn

‘Abbas.*11 Worship is Allah’s Right Then Allah tells us of His greatness, and that worship should be directed to Him alone, not to any of the idols which do not create but are rather themselves created. Thus He says 41\$ then He, Who creates, the same as one who does not create? Will you not then reflect?}(16:17). Then He shows His servants some of the many blessings He granted for them, and the many kinds of things that He has done for them. He says; 4And if you would try to count the favors of Allah, you would never be able to count them. Truly, Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful.} (16:18) meaning that He pardons and forgives them. If He were to ask you to thank Him for all of His blessings, you would not be able to do so, and if He were to command you to do so, you would be incapable of it. If He punishes you. He is never unjust in His punishment, but He is Forgiving and Most Merciful, He forgives much and rewards for little. Ibn Jarir said: “It means that Allah is Forgiving when you fail to thank Him properly, if you repent and turn to Him in obedience, and strive to do that which pleases Him. He is Merciful to you and (i) Al-Tabari 17:185.

445 Surah 16. An-Nahl (19-21) (Part-14) YM % ^ojX-r j> *~^L<i / i T’*’ } *• i/t *, { QM 4j>i ^ J 4il’ 4.^ Ujfrju -. • yj)Ut^L j>uLliu <^L-’)_jU A-»*u’ ^*—s=*aJa v^!IS>^y_U > { <\ \> jfc.yZ* *{• ‘ut’n\J&V does not punish you if you turn to Him and repent.” Cj ^Xr-j ^ *£*. ^j} os 0>I ±^i2 jvJij lid. JyAjt V Alii jjJ y^‘i >-. !‘i .«i. ‘.:•’ “J y—S*& tO*’ *4. ^,|,Oj*>; 04’ 419. And Allah knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} 420. Those whom they invoke besides Allah have not created anything, but are themselves created.} 421. (They are) dead, not alive; and they do not know when they will be resurrected.} Allah tells us that He knows what is hidden in people’s hearts as well as what is apparent. He will reward or punish everyone for their deeds on the Day of Resurrection. If their deeds are good then they will be rewarded, and if their deeds are evil, then they will be punished. The gods of the idolaters are created, they do not create. Then Allah tells us that the idols which people call on instead of Him cannot create anything, they are themselves created, as Al-KhaJS. (Ibrahim) said: 4@\$jES6 \$3L &s ZfUZ U*~&} 4”Do you worship that which you (yourselves) carve? While m Al-Tabari 17:187.

447 Surah 16. An-Nahl (24-25) (Part-14) Allah, and their hearts reject the idea of singling Him out, as Allah says: {Verily! Those who scorn My worship they will surely enter Hell in humiliation/> [40:60] So here, Allah says; {Certainly}, meaning truly, 4oj4^S ^*J ii’ 4^ {Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal. meaning He will requite them for that in full. {Truly, He does not like the proud. (j && 9^ 424. And when it is said to them : "What is it that your Lord has revealed?" They say : "Tales of the men of old!" {25. They will bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge. Evil indeed is that which they shall bear!} The Destruction of the Disbelievers and Intensification of their Punishment for rejecting the Revelation Allah informs us that when it is said to those liars, {\\Z &U} {"What is it that your Lord has revealed?" They say,} not wanting to answer, {"Tales of the men of old!" meaning nothing is revealed to him, what he is reciting to us is just tales of the men of old, taken from the previous Books.

As Allah says, 4 1^=4 iS Jk VjuJ> they say: "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} (2Si5j i.e., they tell lies against the Messenger j\$ and say things contradicting one another, but all of it is false, as Allah says, y ^ / I ** • •! // /i • / // , . » .. 4 j^Lk-s Vi ijU» viii [££ 4Loot at the parables they make of you, so they have gone astray, and they are not able to find the right way.>>(17:48) Once they have gone beyond the bounds of the truth, whatever

they say will be in error. They used to say that he (the Prophet jfe) was a sorcerer, a poet, a soothsayer, or a madman, then they settled on an idea proposed by their leader, an individual known as Al-WalTd bin Al-Mughlrah Al- Makhzumi, when: k & % jtS iHe thought, and plotted. So let him be cursed, how Ik plotted! And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! Then he thought. Then he frowned and he looked in a bad tempered way; then he turned back, and was proud. Then he said: "This is nothing but the magic ofold."} (74:18-24) meaning something that had been transmitted and passed down. So they dispersed having agreed on this opinion, may Allah punish them. iThey will bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of tlw burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge.} meaning, *We decreed that they would say that, so they will carry the burden of their own sins and some of the burden of those who followed them and agreed with them,' i.e., they will be held guilty not only for going astray themselves, but also for tempting others and having them follow them. As it says in

a Hadith Iri J* jyr^ j4 iji ^^ JI ^ j 'j i*B\ ^jA ^UI I {jA 5-lp j IS' iJ^Li JI li-J 1 ll—i J. Ju>>& «Whoever invites people to guidance, he will receive a reward like that of those who follow him, without diminishing their reward in the least. And whoever invites people to misguidance, he will bear a burden of sin like that of those who follow him, without diminishing their burden in the least. a* 1 ' Allah says; g pB iThey shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own; and they shall be questioned about their false allegations on the Day ofResurrection (29:13) Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that it is like the Ayah: jjj\$ Ji) p) ^ iThat they may bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge (16:25) Allah says, pB 4They shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own> (29: 13). Mujahid said: “They will bear the burden of their own sins, and they will bear the sins of those who obeyed them, but that will not lessen the punishment of those who obeyed them at all.”131 <. *i . Ji ii' J6 Oi ^BB ;C\ \K" - -> .-.ir : { > ,i - - o'. ' ***-“• fj* ^ Jt >-**>» o; 111 MusUm 4:2060. 121 At-Tabari 17:191. 131 Af-Tabari 17:190.

450 Tafslr Ibn Kathir \$. 'yS\j ijii\ !>i il\ ij ju ^ k\$ 3fe£ 426. Those before them indeed plotted, but Allah struck at the foundation of their building, the roof fell down upon them from above them, and the torment overtook them from directions they did not perceive.} 427. Then, on the Day of Resurrection, He will disgrace them and will say: "Where are My (so-called) partners, those over which you caused so much discord?" Those who have been given the btowledge will say : "Indeed it is a Day of disgrace and misery for the disbelievers."4 Discussion about what the previous Peoples did, and what was done to Them 4j-£? iThose before than indeed plotted,} Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “This refers to Namrud (Nimrod), who built the tower.” 11 Others said that it refers to Bukhtanassar (Nebuchadnezzar). The correct view is that this is said by way of example, to refute what was done by those who disbelieved in Allah and associated others in worship with Him. As Nuh said, 4"And they have hatched a mighty scheme."} (71:22) meaning, they used all sorts of ploys to misguide their people, and tempted them to join them in their Shirk via all possible means. On the Day of Resurrection their followers will say to them: iZti 2 &jz 4"Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!"} (34:33) (M At-Jabari 17:193.

41^ iii ibut Allah struck at the foundation of their building.} meaning, He uprooted it and brought their efforts to naught. This is like the Ayah: % \fs& u£} iEvery time they kindled the fire of war, Allah

extinguished it.} (5:64) and 4\$» rviK prj?. oyjn, ^ cJiij fjljJSi f j. iif jM !#» 4But Allah's (torment) reached them from a place where they were not expecting it, and He cast terror into their hearts so that they destroyed their own dwellings with their own hands and the hands of the believers. So then take admonition, O you with eyes (to see).} [59:2] Allah says here: « itfat X&S^ c>i ^ ibut Allah struck at the foundation of their building, and then the roof fell down upon them, from above them, and the torment overtook them from directions they did not perceive. Then, on the Day of Resurrection, He will disgrace them} [16:26-27] meaning. He will expose their scandalous deeds and what they used to hide in their hearts, and He will bring it out in the open. As He says, iThe Day when all the secrets will be (exposed and) examined.} (86:9) They will be displayed and made known, as found in the Two Sahihs, where Ibn "Umar reported that the Messenger of Allah said: ij& 5ji :JUj jji j4 udi {£ i'ji jsj

452 Tafoir Ibn Kathir tOn the Day of Resurrection a banner will be set up by his backsidefor every deceitful person, (whose size is) in accordance with the amount of his deceit. It be said, "This is the one who deceived so-and-so, the son ofso-and-so. Thus, what they used to plot in secret will be made public. Allah will humiliate them before all of His creation, and the Lord will say to them, in rebuke and reprimand; uOJI j}} {Where are My (so-called) partners, those over which you caused so much discord?} meaning, you fought and made enemies for their sake, so where are they now to help and save you? {Can they help you or (even) help themselves?} [26:93] {Then will (man) have no power, nor any helper.} [86: 10] When evidence and proof is established against them, and the Word (of Allah) is justified against them, and they will be unable to give any excuse, realizing that escape is impossible, then OJ\ dsM ft} {Those who have been given the knowledge will say} who are the leaders in this world and the Hereafter and who know about the truth in this world and the Hereafter - will say, {ifytfosR jp b\} {Indeed it is a Day ofdisgrace and miseryfor the disbelievers.} meaning, today those who disbelieved in Allah and worshipped others who have no power either to benefit or to harm them are now surrounded by disgrace and punishment. 111 Fath Al-Bdri 10:578 Muslim 3 :1360

2* C iyjti r,,ai1 ^JUi J-4* *ri \$£J» ^ojlllu li ^Jc 42S. Those whose lives the angels take while they are doing wrong to themselves. Then, they will (falsely) submit (saying): "We did not do any evil." (The angels will reply): "Yes! Truly, Allah is Most Knowing ofwhat you did 429. "So enter the gates of Hell, to abide therein, and indeed, what an evil abode there isfor the arrogant."} The Condition ofthe Disbeliever duringand alterDeath Allah informs us of the state of the idolaters who are doing wrong to themselves when death approaches and the angels come to seize their evil souls. 4i^» iThen, they will (falsely) submit meaning, they will make it appear as if they used to listen and obey by saying, 4.t0r* oi S*-*> 1^=» iWe did not do any evil.} Similarly, on the Day of Resurrection, they will say, iBy Allah, our Lord, we were not idolaters.} [6:23] 4^3 CT J) iLp- lii £} 4On the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you.} [58:18] Allah says, rejecting what they say, <^4* 'ti <z~a '(£** ^ Sjili 'iff iij af S) i"Yes! Truly, Allah is Most Knowing of what you did. So enter the gates of Hell, to abide therein, and indeed, what an evil abode there isfor the arrogant."} (16:28-29), meaning, a miserable position in the abode of humiliation for

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir those who were too arrogant to pay atten- tion to the signs of Allah and follow His Messengers. They will enter Hell from the day they die with their souls, and their bodies will feel the heat and hot winds of their graves. When

the Day of Resurrection comes, their souls will be reunited with their bodies, to abide forever in the fire of Hell, and % ^ s,1' >?•> ^I4ji.1t j 4-t- ujj; ilt will not be complete enough to kill them nor shall its torment be lightened for them (35:36) As Allah says, iThe Fire, they are exposed to it morning and afternoon. And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Cause Fir'awn's people to enter the severest torment!"} (40:46). tv msm^ * " ify S > > j"j- m »y y y >rfy > C>JJU 1s £ £.1 Oi' *4 1 ^yyyC #>/'»» J "" »-/ y • £ Lji-' <• . . \$::>/v""' .'.•i.f . - -^ tvfir >i'Y S^i •- '*^4 Q» j JA ^UjujuS j*4-***^ 4jlt ^ f> "x'ty'm'

455 Surah 16. An-Nahl (30-32) (Part-14) 430. And (when) it is said to those who had Taqwa (piety and righteousness), "What is it that your Lord has revealed?" They say: "That which is good." For those who do good in this world, there is good, and the home of the Hereafter will be better. And excellent indeed will be the home (i.e. Paradise) of those who have Taqwa .} 431. 'Adn (Eden) Paradise (Gardens of Eternity) which they will enter, under which rivers flow, in it they will have all that they wish. Thus Allah rewards those who have Taqivd .} 432 . Those whose lives the angels take while they are in a pious state saying (to them) "Saldmun 'Alaikum (peace be on you!). Enter Paradise because of what (good) you used to do (in the world)."} What the Pious say about the Revelation, their Reward and their Condition during and after Death Here we are told about the blessed, as opposed to the doomed, who, when they are asked, ipi& r*> iWhat is it that your Lord has revealed?} they will reluctantly answer, "He did not reveal anything, these are just the fables of old." But the blessed, on the other hand, will say, "That which is good," meaning - He revealed something good, meaning mercy and blessings for those who followed it and believed in it. Then we are told about Allah's promise to His servants which He revealed to His Messengers. He says: C2\ ;Xl ijLjJ ^LjM} }For those wlv do good in this world, there is good} This is like the Ayah, >"*1 i' A /,/\ 3k r+ ' . ,/ ^ .<v W di-j' y Iff y/t'ii/ {> . v •I ^Whoever works righteousness - whether male or female - while being a true believer verily, to him We will give a good life, and We shall certainly reward them in proportion to the best of

{in it they will have all that they wish> this is like the Ayah: Si £5® 5fcj JLiVI^ cu# <in it (there will be) all that souls could desire, and all that eyes could delight in, and in it you will live forever.} [43:71] fir jfc\$f} {Thus Allah rewards those who have Taqwa.} meaning, this is how Allah rewards everyone who believes in Him, fears Him, and does good deeds. Then Allah tells us about their condition when death approaches them in a good state, i.e., free from Shirk, impurity and all evil. The angels greet them and give them the good news of Paradise, as Allah says: \&2% \j>a SjcZ p fit C& \J6 l\} \$ alii a\$\$& ^ ^ 04 *0 £Oi j£3j £Oo fCb {Verily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah (alone)," and then behave righteously, on them the angels will descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the good news of Paradise as you have been promised! I've have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. In it you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and in it you shall have (all) that you ask for. An entertainment from (Allah), the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."^(41:30:32) We have already referred to the Hadiths that have been reported on the taking of the soul of the believer and the soul of the disbeliever, when we discussed the Ayah, firU& t±9 Qlii i £'•^ fir £ fir fcj {Allah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world (i.e. they will keep on worshipping Allah Alone and none else), and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the wrongdoers to stray, and Allah does as He wills.} (14:27)

458 Tafclr Ibn Kathtr K %£ iSSp\$% j &*Pl J%U& &) i; ^ jCj #£££££ 'J&X \$£, j&%%& * > V£ <33. Are they but waiting for the angels to come to them, or there comes the command of your Lord? Thus did those before them. And Allah did not wrong them, but they were wronging themselves.) 434. Then, they were afflicted by their evil deeds, and they were surrounded by that which they used to mock.) The Disbelievers' Refrain from Faith means that They were simply awaiting Punishment Threatening the idolaters for their persistence in falsehood and their conceited delusions about this world, Allah says: Are these people waiting only for the angels to come and take their souls? Qatadah said: 40r there comes the command of your Lord?) means the Day of Resurrection and the terror that they will go through." Ji) 4Thus did those before them.) means, thus did their predecessors and those who were like them among the idolaters persist in their Shirk, until they tasted the wrath of Allah and experienced the punishment and torment that they suffered. \Zj) 4And Allah did not wrong them.) because by sending His Messengers and revealing His Books He gave them enough warning and clearly demonstrated His proofs to them. &&W£%) ibut they were wronging themselves.) meaning, by opposing the Messengers and denying what they brought. For this reason m At-Tabari 17:199.

TVN msmsT%, {j*tJL-jcU 4jjiiL-ip 'Sj ill' 1) Vj4j J^rs^LijuJuilj(^ • i > ; ^>ir /' > » <*>" > t-,ff>. <-j> 4JS' j>-\$Utily'ml (g) L*j ^4-i-y^dji p piUpL-ilj \&£kj!4>^u\$J®&£££ Allah's punishment tormented them. irfi ithey were surrounded> meaning, they were overwhelmed by the painful torment. 44»*jr-i 'it \yf^ 4by that which they used to mock.\$ meaning, they used to make fun of the Messengers when they warned them Allah's punish- ment, and for this it will be said to them on the Day of Resurrection: VS* £ \$ p3 iThis is die Fire which you used to belie. (52:14). J \&\ JSj> }& Ji 'fb* ck X> 'lift** J* t<r o# 'i-iJ* 4j C Sf iLi J^=* 4 CJ1 jjJJ '^C5_p! j^Jl ^ jlpf Jb Jv >+U 4; J«i4'T OJj- O jbj 4JJ> 4* p4 :.i OydaN ilt \jjld '~r^ "5?AJ Sil Jc 4) JLj^a 4 <j* >+i j~4 0* 4>r. V ilf 435. And those who worshipped others with Allah said: "If Alliih had so willed, neither we nor our fathers would have worshipped any but Him nor would we have forbidden anything without (a command from) Him." Those before them did the same. Then! Are the Messengers charged with anything but to

clearly convey the Message?} 436. And We have indeed sent a Messenger to every Ummah (community, nation) (saying): "Worship Allah (Alone), and shun the Taghiit (all false deities)." Then among them were some whom Allah guided, and among them were some who deserved to be left to stray. So travel through the land and see

the end of those who denied (the truth).}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3000–3011]

437. [Even] if you desire that they be guided, then verily, Allah does not guide those whom He allowed to stray, and they will have no helpers.} The Idolaters Argument that their Shirk was Divinely decreed, and the Refutation of thin Claim Allah tells us about the idolaters delusion over their Shirk, and the excuse they claimed for it based on the idea that it is ordained by divine decree. He says: <Ji Cti X, tjtl. 'jj jVi l> lai \$} Hi 4(They say:) "If Allah had so willed, neither we nor our fathers would have worshipped any but Him, nor would we have forbidden anything without (a command from) Him."} They had superstitious customs dealing with certain animals, e.g. the Bahirahl] the Sa'ibah and the WasQah and other things that they had invented and innovated by themselves, with no revealed

authority. The essence of what they said was: "If Allah hated what we did, He would have stopped by punishing us, and He would not have enabled us to do it." Rejecting their confusing ideas, Allah says: 4**k \$&} 4Are the Messengers charged with anything but to clearly convey the Message?} meaning, the matter is not as you claim. It is not the case that Allah did not rebuke your behavior; rather, He did rebuke you, and in the strongest possible terms, and He emphatically !i| See the Tafsir of Surah Yunus nos . 59-60

461 Surah 16. An-Nahl (35-37) (Part-14) forbade you from such behavior. To every nation - that is, to every generation, to every community of people - He sent a Messenger. All of the Messengers called their people to worship Allah (Alone) as well as forbidding them from worshipping anything or anybody except for Him. lilt 'jilt' ^Worship Allah (Alone), and shun the Tdghiit (all false deities).} Allah continued sending Messengers to mankind with this Message, from the first incidence of Shirk that appeared among the Children of Adam, in the people to whom NQh was sent - the first Messenger sent by Allah to the people of this earth - until He sent the final Messenger, Muhammad jg|, whose call was addressed to both men and Jinn, in the east and in the west. All of the Messengers brought the same Message, as Allah says: 4 : ft Vi\ V % 4\ &j>% Jj i—: i"" \" 4And We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad) but We revealed to him (saying): None has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah), so worship Me (alone and none else)."} (21:25) 4And ask (O Muhammad) those Messengers of Ours whom We sent before you: "Did We ever appointed to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious (Allah)?" (43:45) And in this Ayahi tnis Ayan, rnian says: 43.JM ij sit |#tf jj* d^ 4 ££ Zij} 4And We have indeed sent a Messenger to every Umtnah (community, nation) (saying): "Worship Allah (alone), and shun the Taghiit (all false deities)."} So how could any of the idolators say, 4}& Ot i Si t j!^ 41f Allah had so willed, we would not have worshipped any but Him,}

462 Tafsir Ibirt Kathir The legislative will of Allah is clear and cannot be taken as an excuse by them, because He had forbidden them to do that upon the tongue of His Messengers, but by His universal will [i.e., by which He allows things to occur even though they do not please Him] He allowed them to do that as it was decreed for them. So there is no argument in that for them. Allah created Hell and its people both the Shayatin (devils) and disbelievers, but He does not like His servants to disbelieve. And this point constitutes the strongest proof and the most unquestionable wisdom. Then Allah informs us that He rebuked them with punishment in this world, after the Messengers issued their warning, thus He says: O* (v4~y iSJL* a iThen among them were some whom Allah guided, and among them were some who deserved to be left to stray. So travel through the land and see the end of those who denied (the truth). This means: ask about what happened to those who went against the Messengers and rejected the truth, see how: && ?>} iAllah destroyed them completely, and a similar (end awaits) the disbelievers .> (47:10) and, ^ ^j} 4And indeed those before them belied (the Messengers of Allah), so then how terrible was My denial (punishment)?} (67:18) Then Allah told His Messenger sg| that His eagerness to guide them will be of no benefit to them if Allah wills that they should be misguided, as He says: iAnd for whoever Allah wills to try with error, you can do nothing far him against Allah} (5:41). Nuh said to his people:

J i;_ ift if a) " -1 i A O' o\ Li & 4 "And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, if Allah's will is to keep you astray."^(1 1:34). In this Ayah, Allah says: 4 j-i« V iji 4(Even) if

you desire that they be guided, then verily, Allah does not guide those whom He allowed to stray,} As Allah says: ^Whomsoever Allah allows to stray, then there is no guide for him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgressions.} (7:186) \>~ -v .1' iTruly! Those deserving the Word (wrath) of your Lord will not believe, even if every sign should come to them - until they see the painful torment (10:96-97). 4then verily, Allah meaning, this is the way in which Allah does things. If He wills a thing, then it happens, and if He does not will a thing, then it does not happen. For this reason Allah says: 4 J-i" <***r. 4Allah does not guide those whom He allowed to stray,} meaning the one whom He has caused to go astray, so who can guide him apart from Allah? No one. 4<Czr£ £3} 4And they will have no helpers.} means, they will have no one to save them from the punishment of Allah, 4Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is

Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} (7:54). UJ !£)J fo ^ i *^1 it \0S\{f} <©\$& *\$ j^% Sv^i\$ i2» 43S. And they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up one who dies. Yes, (He will raise them up), a promise (binding) upon Him in truth, but most of mankind know not 439. In order that He may make clear to them what they differed over, and so that those who disbelieved may know that they were liars. 440. Verily, Our Word to a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it: "Be!" - and it is.} The Resurrection after Death is true, there is Wisdom behind it, and it is easy for Allah Allah tells us that the idolators swore by Allah their strongest oaths, meaning that they made oaths swore fervently that Allah would not resurrect the one who died. They considered that to be improbable, and did not believe the Messengers when they told them about that, swearing that it could not happen. Allah said, refuting them: 4Yes}, meaning it will indeed happen, IMj} 4a promise (binding) upon Him in truth,} - meaning it is inevitable, ibut most of mankind know not.} means, because of then- ignorance they oppose the Messengers and fall into disbelief. Then Allah mentions His wisdom and the reason why He will resurrect mankind physically on the Day of Calling (between the people of Fire and of Paradise). He says,

465Surah 16. An-Nahl (38-40 (Part-14 iltt order that He may make clear to them} means, to mankind, iwhat they differed over,} means, every dispute. £3 iSiS)& u* i\jd sM%%} ithat He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done (i.e. punish them in Hell), and reward those who do good, with what is best (i.e. Paradise).} (53:31) iand so that those who disbelieved may know that they were liars.} meaning that they lied in their oaths and their swearing that Allah would not resurrect those who die. Thus they will be pushed down by force to the Fire with horrible force on the Day of Resurrection, and the guards of Hell will say to them: c sp 142 ji%% iThis is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste its heat, and whether you are tolerant of it or intolerant of it - it is all the same. You are only being requitedfor what you have done.} (52:14-16). Then Allah tells us about His ability to do whatever He wills, and that nothing is impossible for Him on earth or in heaven. When He wants a thing, all He has to do is say to it "Be!" and it is. The Resurrection is one such thing, when He wants it to happen, all He will have to do is issue the command once, and it will happen as He wills, as He says: •-*-«£» ^1 tj} iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) and, <iw -Si jB?% \»» iThe creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only as (the creation and resurrection of) a single person.} (31:28) And in this Ayah, Allah says:

466 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir V j' >1 -V . /i X .y . J Jyi J aljjj' 'ij Uy Lj>^ 4Wn7y, Our Word to a thing when We intend it, is only that We say to it: "Be!" - and it is.} meaning, We issue the command once, and then it happens. Allah does not need to repeat or confirm whatever He commands, because there is nothing that can stop Him or oppose Him. He is the One, the Compelling, the Almighty, whose power, might and dominion have subjected all things. None has the right to be worshipped except Him, and there is no Lord other than Him. jj 'jH;^ aii? j I# c* ii& j sj?j> 442 . And as for those who emigrated for the cause of Allah, after they had been wronged, We will certainly give them good residence in this world, but indeed the reward of the Hereafter will be greater; if they but knew!} 442. (They are) those who remained patient, and put their trust in their Lord.} The Reward of the Muhajirin Allah tells us about the reward of those who migrated for His sake, seeking His pleasure, those who left their homeland behind, brothers and friends, hoping for the reward of Allah. This may have been revealed concerning those who migrated to Ethiopia, those whose persecution at the hands of their own people in Makkah was so extreme that they left them and went to Ethiopia so that they would be able to worship their Lord. Among the most prominent of these migrants were Tjthman bin 'Affan and his wife Ruqayyah, the daughter of the Messenger of Allah JaTar bin Abi Talib, the cousin of the Messenger jg, and Abu Salamah bin 'Abdul-Asad, among a group of almost eighty sincere and faithful men and women, may Allah be pleased with them. Allah promised them a great reward in this world and the next. Allah said: 4We will certainly give them good residence in this world,}

467 Surah 16. An-Nahl (43-44) (Part-14) Ibn 'Abbas, Ash-Sha'bi and Qatadah said: (this means) "Al-Madlnah." It was also said that it meant "good provision". This was the opinion of Mujahid.^{12*} There is no contradiction between these two opinions, for they left their homes and wealth, but Allah compensated them with something better in this world. Whoever gives up something for the sake of Allah, Allah compensates him with something that is better for him than that, and this is what happened. He gave them power throughout the land and caused them to rule over the people, so they became governors and rulers, and each of them became a leader of the pious. Allah tells us that His reward for the Muhajirin in the Hereafter is greater than that which He gave them in this world, as He says: & 'M> 4but indeed the reward of the Hereafter will be greater} meaning, greater than that which We have given you in this world. 4if they but knew!} means, if those who stayed behind and did not migrate with them only knew what Allah prepared for those who obeyed Him and followed His Messenger jg. Then Allah describes them as: ^ s&i a\$} 4those who remained patient, and put their trust in their Lord.} (16:42), meaning, they bore their people's persecution with patience, putting their trust in Allah Who made their end good in this world and the Hereafter. V 'JX ol jil' j-ii 1 XT# ^ .01 iXji tj} 443. And I've sent not (as Our Messengers) before you (O At-Tabari 17:205, 206. At-Tabari 17:206.

Muhammad) any but men, whom We sent revelation. So ask Ahl Adh-Dhikr, if you know not.) 444. With clear signs and Books (We sent the Messengers). And We have also revealed the Dhikr to you so that you may clearly explain to men what was revealed to them, and that perhaps they may reflect.} Only Human Messengers have been Sent Ad-Dahhak said, reporting from Ibn 'Abbas: "When Allah sent Muhammad jg as a Messenger, the Arabs, or some of them, denied him and said, 'Allah is too great to send a human being as a Messenger.' Then Allah revealed: o' fr-J j', tL A ojllll 41s it a wonder to people that We have sent Our Inspiration to a man from among themselves (saying) : "Warn mankind. . ."} and He said, V^ o\ pt iil & uy J „r*> » 4And We sent not (as Our Messengers) before you (O Muhammad)

any but men, whom We sent Revelation. So ask Ahl Adh-Dhikr, if you know not.}. meaning, (ask) the people of the previous Books, were the Messengers that were sent to them humans or angels? If they were angels, then you have the right to find this strange, but if they were human, then you have no grounds to deny that Muhammad is a Messenger. Allah says: *ir a 4And We sent not before you (us Messengers) any but men to whom We revealed, from among the people of townships.} [12:109] and not from among the people of heaven as you say."* 111 It was reported by Mujahid from Ibn 'Abbas that what is meant in At-Jabari 17:208.

by Ahl Adh-Dhikr is the People of the Book. 111 This is as Allah says: *4Say: "Glorified be my Lord! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?" And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said: "Has Allah sent a man as (His) Messenger?"} (17:93-94) 4^ \$ VI U iXi Zj} 4And We never sent before you (O Muhammad) any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets.} (25:20) \$ ly oJ^=>C V IxX Zj} 4And We did not create them (the Messengers, with) bodies that did not eat food, nor were they immortals.} (21:8) 4S~)\ <Si £-h <£ U 4Say (O Muhammad jfi): "I am not a new thing among the Messengers."} [46:9], 43) fry. I&t 4Say (O Muhammad): "I am only a man like you. It has been revealed to me."} [18:110] Then Allah informs those who doubt that a Messenger can be a human to ask those who have knowledge of the previous Scriptures about the Prophets who came before: were their Prophets humans or angels? Then Allah mentions that He has sent them, *iwith clear signs}, meaning proof and evidence, and Al-Tabari 17:208.**

J TVT t&smir\, 0Jr'^*oZ&lcj£Z}j^==,j}l (fp^~y^i.p-* 4 o' J»lUj Oji^oitjOjtO Ij jl\ij0«£/ 4so that perhaps they may reflect.} meaning, they should examine themselves and be guided by it, so that they may attain the victory of salvation in this world and the next. *j yt ya» >jV' Pj; «sl JLi » "*" .< > .y » 1V / ff <&•!/*—i ^ ^-e- j: > • •'*. .>/>!, < (** Ui (viji-S j' >jii jl -*£=> '-bv <45. Do then those who devise evil plots feel se- cure that Allah will not cause them to sink into the earth, or that tor- ment will not seize them \from where they do not perceive it?} 446. Or that He may punish them in the midst of their going to and fro (in their livelihood), so that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)?} 447. Or that He may punish them where they fear it most? Indeed, Your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful.}*

How the Guilty can feel Secure

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3011–3029]

Allah informs us about His patience, and how He delays the punishment for the sinners who do evil things and call others to do likewise, plotting to call others to do evil - even though He is able to make the earth swallow them or to bring His wrath upon them.

ifrom where they do not perceive it}, meaning in such a way that they do not know where it comes from. As Allah says: jm 4 j ft o. & P>^ oi 4 j JT^££3 t-ft££ 54X 4Do you feel secure that He Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause you to sink into the earth, when it quakes? Or do you feel secure that He Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send a storm of stones upon you? Then you shall know how My warning really is.} (67:16-17). iOr that He may punish them in the midst of their going to and fro meaning, when they are busy with their daily business, travel, and other distracting activities.

Qatadah and As-Suddi said: 44&} iTheir going to andfro} means theirjourneys.” 1 11 As Allah says: r&fc J 'J i K J 'JZ} pi^ax iDid the people of the towns feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} (7:97- 98) r*^ iso that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)?} meaning, it is not impossible for Allah, no matter what their situation. iOr that He may punish them where theyfear it most?} meaning, or Allah will take from them what they most fear, (M At-Tabari 17:213.

which is even more frightening, because when the thing you most fear to happen does happen, this is even worse. Hence Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that, £ >iX ii 40r that He may punish them where theyfear it most?}\$ means that Allah is saying: If I wish, I can take him after the death of his companion and after he has become frightened of that.’*’ This was also reported from Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others. 121 Then Allah says: ^Indeed your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful.> meaning, because He does not hasten to punish, as was reported in the Two Sahihs: Ij* «**<> *No one is more patient in the case of hearing offensive speech than Allah, for they attribute to Him a son, while He [alone] is giving them provision and good health. And it is also recorded in Two Sahihs, p Jiif \i\ Ji- pJUai Sil 01. *Allah will let the wrongdoer continue until, when He begins to punish him, He will never let him goJ Then the Messenger of Allah jg recited: %S\ jf, 2J til iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Indeed, His punishment is painful, (and) severe (11:102) And Allah says: 111 At-Tabari 17:214. 121 At-Tabari 17:215. 131 Fath Al-Bari 13 :372 , Muslim 4 :2160. 141 Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997

their prostrations are their shadows. Abu Ghalib Ash-Shaybani said: “The waves of the sea are its prayers”. It is as if reason is attributed to these inanimate objects when they are described as prostrating, so Allah says: - i l»j 4 U *kj} 4And to Allah prostrate all that are in the heavens and all that are in the earth, of the moving creatures} As Allah says: O- -W-> jHjJ 4And to Allah (alone) all who are in the heavens and the earth fall in prostration, willingly or unwillingly, and so do their shadows in the mornings and in the afternoons.} (13:15) iand the angels, and they are not proud.} means, they prostrate to Allah and are not too proud to worship Him. iThey fear their Lord above them} means, they prostrate out of fear of their Lord, may He be glorified. iand they do what they are commanded.} meaning they continually obey Allah, doing what He tells them to do and avoiding that which He forbids. 4 £ % 'J\$ VS j> ^ stf J'u ,r, &*\$**& s > -if >C/ .Iff- >-> 4Jl> j-*-* igj&l & tkV fii jfc 51* a2" 6|2 4 «K y <•". \ x- ; “s',. ' >«» > 4V 1 * “f llyoU 451. And Allah said “Do not worship two gods. Indeed, He (Allah) is only One God. Then fearMe Alone.} 452. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth and the religion. Will you then fear any other than Allah?} 453 . And whatever of blessings and good things you have, it is from Allah. Then, when harm touchtes you, unto Him you cry

aloudfor help> <54. Then, when He has removed the harm from you, behold! some of you associate others in worship with their Lord (Allah)) 455. So they are ungrateful for that which We have given them! Then enjoy yourselves but you will soon come to know) Allah Alone is Deserving ofWorship Allah tells us that there is no god but He, and that no one else should be worshipped except Him, alone, without partners, for He is the Sovereign, Creator, and Lord of all things. iHis is the religion Wasiba} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Maymun bin Mahran, As- Suddi, Qatadah and others said that this

means forever. * It was also reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “It means obligatory.”*2 * Mujahid said: “It means purely for Him,” i.e., worship is due to Him Alone, from whoever is in the heavens and on earth. As Allah says: *4>1j yi 4 ir* nlj 4*’ irii jS*1’ iDo they seek other than the religion of AllSh, while to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned) (3:83) This is in accordance with the opinion of Ibn ‘Abbas and ‘Ikrimah, which is that this Ayah is merely stating the case. According to the opinion of Mujahid, it is by way of instruction, i.e., it is saying: You had better fear associating partners in worship with Me, and be sincere in your obedience to Me. As Allah says: i'Mf ctJira yi» At-Tabari 17:222. > At-Tabari 17:223.

477Surah 16. Ati-Nahl (51-55) (Part-14) iSurely, the pure religion (sincere devotion) is for Allah only.} (39:3) Then Allah tells us that He is the One Who has the power to benefit and harm, and that the provisions, blessings, good health and help, His servants enjoy are from His bounty and graciousness towards them. iThen, when harm touches you, to Him you cry aloud for help.} meaning because you know that none has the power to remove that harm except for Him, so when you are harmed, you turn to ask Him for help and beg Him for aid. As Allah says: oty jji' Ji V) 3 fCS* \>£} iAnd when harm touches you at sea, those that you call upon vanish, except for Him. But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away. And man is ever ungrateful.}(17:67) Here, Allah tells us: t,!*!m£m %» iThen, when He has removed the harm from you, behold! some of you associate others in worship with their Lord (Allah). So they are ungrateful for that which We have given them!} (16:54-55) It was said that the Ldm here (translated as “So”) is an indicator of sequence, or that it serves an explanatory function, meaning, “We decreed that they would conceal the truth and deny the blessings that Allah has bestowed upon them. He is the One Who bestows blessings and the One Who removes distress.’ Then Allah threatens them, saying: iThen enjoy yourselves} meaning, do what you like and enjoy what you have for a little while.

457. And they assign daughters to Allah! Glorified (and Exalted) is He (above all that they associate with Him!). And for themselves (they assign) what they desire;} 458. And when the news of (the birth of) a female (child) is brought to any of them, his face becomes dark, and he is filled with inner grief!} 459. He hides himself from the people because of the evil of what he has been informed. Shall he keep her with dishonor or bury her in the earth? Certainly, evil is their decision.} 460. For those who do not believe in the Hereafter is an evil description, and for Allah is the highest description. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.}

Among the Behavior of the Idolators was vowing to Things that Allah had provided for Them to their gods Allah tells us about some of the heinous deeds of those who used to perform baseless worship of other gods besides Him, such as idols and statues, with no grounds for doing so. They gave their idols a share of that which Allah had provided for them, 4 .’H, L ^ ’j[j— ji 477iei/ say: "This is for Allah," according to their claim, "and this is for our partners." But the share of their "partners" is not directed to Allah, while the share of Allah is directed to their "partners"! How evil is that with which they judged (6:136) That is they assigned a share for their idols as well as Allah, but they gave preference to their gods over Him, so Allah swore by His Almighty Self to question them about these lies and fabrications. He will most certainly call them to account for it and give them the unrelenting punishment in the fire of Hell. So He says, 4By Allah, you shall certainly be questioned about (all) that you used to fabricate.}

Then Allah tells us how they used to regard the angels, who are servants of the Most Merciful, as being female, and that they considered them to be Allah's daughters, and they worshipped them with Him. In all of the above, they made very serious errors. They attributed offspring to Him when He has no offspring, then they assigned Him the kind of offspring they regarded as inferior, namely daughters, which they did not even want for themselves, as He said: *Are the males for you and the females for Him? That is indeed an unfair division!* (53:21-22) And Allah says here:

male children over her? or bury her in the earth?} meaning bury her alive, as they used to do during the days of ignorance. How could they dislike something so intensely, yet attribute it to Allah? 4Certainly, evil is their decision.} meaning how evil are the words they say, the way they want to share things out and the things they attribute to Him. As Allah says: 4And if one of them is informed of the news of (the birth of a girl) that which he sets forth as a parable to the Most Gracious (Allah), his face becomes dark, and he is filled with grief!} (43:17). Here, Allah says: 4For those who do not believe in the Hereafter there is an evil description,} meaning, only imperfection is to be attributed to &&K iandfor Allah is the highest description} meaning He is absolutely perfect in all ways and this absolute perfection is His Alone. 4And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} &p A 3 1# £} v Vj ^ >4-U» &&A % *&#&^ 461. And if Allah were to punish (all) mankind for their wrongdoing. He would not leave on it (the earth) a single moving creature, but He defers them to an appointed term ; and when their term comes, they can neither delay nor advance it an hour (or a moment).}

462. They assign to Allah that which they dislike (for themselves), and their tongues assert the lie that the better things will be theirs. No doubt the Fire is for them, and they will be forsaken. Allah does not immediately punish for Disobedience Allah tells us about His patience with His creatures, even though they do wrong. If He were to punish them for what they have done, there would be no living creature left on the face of the earth, i.e., He would have destroyed every animal on earth after destroying the sons of Adam. But the Lord - magnificent is His gloiy - is forbearing and He covers people's faults. He waits until the appointed time, i.e.. He does not rush to punish them. If He did, then there would be no one left. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Salamah said: "Abu Hurayrah heard a man saying, The wrongdoer harms no one but himself.' He turned to him and said, That is not true, by Allah! Even the buzzard dies in its nest because of the sins of the wrongdoer.'" They attribute to Allah what They Themselves dislike 4They assign to Allah that which they dislike (for themselves), meaning, daughters, and partners, who are merely His servants, yet none of them would like to have someone sharing in his wealth. ifcii% d} 4and their tongues assert the lie that the better things will be theirs.} This is a denunciation of their claims that better things will be theirs in this world, and in the Hereafter. Allah tells us about what some of them said, as in the Ayat: m At-Tabari 17:231.

4And if We give man a taste of mercy from Us, and then take it from him, verily! He is hopelessly, ungrateful. But if We let him taste of goodness after harm has touched him, he is sure to say: "Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is cheerful, and boastful (ungrateful to Allah).} (11:9-10) i-jli icLU 'ii ifjfi I Xu llj ijiue- lij li ilxt. ^ 4And if We give him a taste of mercy from Us, after some adversity has touched him, he is sure to say: "This is due to me; I do not think that the Hour will occur. But if I am brought back to my Lord, then , with Him, there will surely be the best for me." Then, We will certainly show the disbelievers what they have done, and We shall make them taste severe torment.} (41:50) 4

£*£& jkkza ifjil }Have you seen the one who disbelieved in Our Ayat and said: "I shall certainly be given wealth and children (if I came back to life)."} (19:77) Allah tells us about one of the two men: C_> jjjC* xS J 1)^ C Jtt .«—iJ Jij /cjj-. £*} I L**- oju-V ^ oyj a^L_» 4He went into his garden while wronging himself. He said : "I do not think that this will ever perish. And I do not think that the Hour will ever come, and if indeed I am brought back to my Lord, (on the Day of Resurrection), then surely, I shall find better than this when I return to Him."} (18:35-36) These people combined bad deeds with the false hopes of being rewarded with good for those bad deeds, which is impossible. Thus Allah refuted their false hopes, when He said: I 4No doubt}, meaning, truly it is inevitable that

484 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ifor them is the Fire), meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. iand they will be forsaken). Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and others said: "This means they will be forgotten and neglected there." * This is like the Ayah: 4ji 4So today We forget them just as they forgot meeting on this day of theirs.) (7:51). It was also reported from Qatadah that, 4they will be forsaken) means *they are hastened into the Fire.' 121 There is no contradiction between the two, because they will be hastened into the Fire on the Day of Resurrection, then they will be forgotten there, i.e., left to dwell there for eternity. taz u, 4£ zs^ yz /f) ijif JIM 0>jV' * (fX '%> tdii & Jf iifj fjA 463. By Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you, but Shaytan made their deeds seeming fair to them. So today he is their helper, and theirs will be a painful torment.) 464. And We have not revealed the Book to you, except that you may clearly explain to them those things in which they differ, and (as) a guidance and a mercy for a people who believe.) 465. And Allah sends water down from the sky, then He revives the earth with it after its death . Surely that is a sign for people who listen.) 111 At-Jabari 17:233. 121 At-Jabari 17:234.

Finding Consolation in the Reminder of Those Who came before Allah says. He sent Messengers to the nations of the past, and they were rejected. You, O Muhammad, have an example in your brothers among the Messengers, so do not be distressed by your people's rejection. As for the idolators' rejection of the Messengers, the reason for this is that the Shaytdn made their deeds attractive to them.' 4So today he (Shaytdn) is their helper,} meaning they will be suffering punishment while Shaytdn is their only helper, and he cannot save them, so they have no one to answer their calls for help, and theirs is a painful punishment. The Reasonwhy the Qur'an was revealed Then Allah says to His Messenger jg that He has revealed the Book to him to explain the truth to mankind in matters which they dispute over. So the Qur'&n is a decisive arbitrator for every issue that they argue about. iand (as) a guidance} meaning, for their hearts. iand a mercy} meaning, for the one who adheres to it. ifor a people who believe.} Just as Allah causes the Qur'an to bring life to hearts that were dead from disbelief, so He brings the earth to life after it has died, by sending down water from the sky. i'ofill 4,7 lifl'i j, iSurely that is a sign for people who listen.} meaning those who understand the words and their meanings.

mixed with another after separating, and none of them is affected by the other. iUtrM {pure milk; palatable to the drinkers.> meaning nothing to cause one to choke on it. When Allah mentions milk and how He has made it a palatable drink for mankind, He follows this with a reference to the drinks that people make from the fruits of the date palm and grapevine, and what they used to do with intoxicating Nabidh (drink made from dates) before it was forbidden. Thus He reminds them of His blessings, and says: 4£^=«- o>5m} {And from the fruits of date palms and grapes, you derive strong drink} This

indicates that it was permissible to drink it before it was forbidden. It also indicates that strong drink (i.e., intoxicating drink) derived from dates is the same as strong drink derived from grapes. Also forbidden are strong drinks derived from wheat, barley, corn and honey, as is explained in detail in the Sunnah. 4 feu {r^=i^} •{strong drink and a goodly provision.} Ibn ‘Abbas said: “Strong drink is the product of these two fruits that is forbidden, and the good provision is what is permitted of them.” According to another report: “Strong drink is its unlawful, and the goodly provision is its lawful, ”,21 referring to the fruits when they are dried, like dates and raisins, or products derived from them such as molasses, vinegar and wine (of grapes, dates) which are permissible to drink before they become strong (becomes alcoholic), as was stated in the Sunnah. life ^ b\} {There is indeed a sign in this for those of reason.} 111 At-Tabari 17:241. 121 At-Tabari 17:242.

a drink of varying colors, in which there is a cure for men. There is indeed a sign in that for people who reflect. In the Bee and its Honey there is Blessing and a Lesson

What is meant by inspiration here is guidance. The bee is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3029–3040]

guided to make its home in the mountains, in trees and in structures erected by man. The bee’s home is a solid structure, with its hexagonal shapes and interlocking forms there is no looseness in its combs. Then Allah decrees that the bee will have permission to eat from all fruits and to follow the ways which Allah has made easy for it, wherever it wants to go in the vast spaces of the wilderness, valleys and high mountains. Then each bee comes back to its hive without swerving to the right or left, it comes straight back to its home where its offspring and honey are. It makes wax from its wings, and regurgitates honey from its mouth, and lays eggs from its rear, then the next morning it goes out to the fields again. and follow the routes of your Lord made easy (for you)) Qatadah and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: “This means, in an obedient way”,’21 understanding it to be a description of the route of migration. Ibn Zayd said that this is like the Ayah: 4 And We have subdued them for them so that some they may ride and some they may eat.) (36:72)*31 He said: “Do you not see that they move the bees’ home from one land to another, and the bees follow them?” The first opinion is clearly the more likely, as it describes the routes that the bees follow, i.e., “follow these routes as they are easy” The word translated here as “made easy” is Dhululan. This may be understood as meaning “made easy”, in which case it refers to the routes followed by the bees, or it may be understood as meaning “subjugated”, in which case it refers to the bees themselves. These two scholarly interpretations are the two opinions discussed here ,21 At-Tabari 17:249. 131 At-Tabari 17:249.

for you.’ This was stated by Mujahid. Ibn Jarir said that both opinions are correct. iThere comes forth from their bellies, a drink of varying colors, wherein is healing for men.} [meaning, honey, that is] white, yellow, red, or of other good colors, depending on the different things that the bees eat. iM tin which there is a cure for men.} meaning there is a cure in honey for diseases that people suffer from. Some of those who spoke about the study of Prophetic medicine said that if [Allah] had said, ‘in which there is the cure for men’, then it would be the remedy for all diseases, but He said, “in which there is a cure for men”, meaning that it is the right treatment for every “cold” disease, because it is “hot”, and a disease should be treated with its opposite. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded in their Sahih

from Qatadah from Abu Al-Mutawakkil 'Ali bin Dawud An-Naji from Abu Said Al-Khudri thatameincame to the MessengerofAllah \$gg and said, "My brother is suffering from diarrhea". He said, *iGivehim honey to drink.*Themanwentand gave him honey, then hecamebackand said, "O Messenger ofAllah! Igavehimhoney to drink,andheonlygotworse."TheProphet said, ji-U JJoll «Go and give him honey to drink.* So he went and gave him honey, then he came back and said, "O Messenger of Allah! it only made him worse." The Prophet jg said, *Allah speaks the truth and your brother's stomach is lying. Go and give him honey to drink. So he went and gave him honey, and he recovered."|2' 111 At-Tabari 17:249. 121 Path Al-Bari 10:178, Muslim 4 : 1732

It is reported in the Two Sahdis from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that the Messenger of Allah used to like sweet things and honey. This is the wording of Al-Bukhari, who also reported in his Sahih from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger ofAllah said: p)* •'p'i - Jt uJ «Healing is to be found in three things: the cut made by the cupper, or drinking honey, or in branding withfire (cauterizing), but Ihaveforbiddenmy Urnmah to usebranding.^ 4djpCd; d# l) (j\} iThere is indeed a sign in that for people who reflect.} meaning in the fact that Allah inspires this weak little creature to travel through the vast fields and feed from every kind of fruit, then gather it for wax and honey, which are some of the best things, in this is a sign for people who think about the might and power of the bee's Creator Who causes all of this to happen. From this they learn that He is the Initiator, the All- Powerful, the All-Wise, the All-Knowing, the Most Generous, the Most Merciful. k te Z& V&pg & % * &P* >& 470. And Allah created you and then He will cause you to die; and among you there are some who are sent back to senility, so that they know nothing after having known (much). Truly, Allah is Knowing, capable of all things.} InMan there is a Lesson Allah tells us that He is controlling the affairs of His servants. He is the One Who created them out of nothing, then He will cause them to die. But there are some of them that He allows to grow old, which is a physical weakness, as Allah says: 111 FathAl-B6ri 10 :81 , Muslim 2 :1101 121 Path Al-Bari 10:143.

t*y -u> t>? j*»- ^4 rtXJiU- c^jJ' <a>^ is He Who created i/om in (a state of) weakness, then gave you strength after weakness, then after strength gave (you) weakness} (30:54) iso that they know nothing after lowing known.} meaning, after he knew things, he will reach a stage where he knows nothing because of weakness of mind due to old age and senility. Thus Al-Bukhari, when commenting on this Ayah, reported a narration from Anas bin Malik that the Messenger of Allah sg used to pray: •oLLU \j Lpv-kJl Oj "I seek refuge with You from miserliness, laziness, old age, senility, the punishment of the grave, the Fitnah of the Dajjdl and the trials of life and deathM*' Zuhayr bin Abi Sulma said, in his famous Mu'allaqah:i2] "I became exhausted from the responsibilities of life. Whoever lives for eighty years, no wonder he is tired. I saw death hitting people like a crazed camel, and whoever it hit dies, but whoever is not hit lives until he grows old." i71. And Allah honored some ofyou over others with wealth and properties. Then, those who are so honored will by no means hand over their wealth and properties to those (captives of war) whom their right hands possess, so that they may be equal with them in that. Do they then deny thefavor ofAllah?} 111 Path Al-Bari 8:239 Mu'allaqah (lit. "suspended"): during the days of Jahiliyyah, poetry , in the form of the Qasldahs or odes , was the only means of literary expression. Seven Qasldahs which were masterpieces of their genre were suspended on the walls of the Ka'bah. They are known as the "Seven Mu'aUaqat".

493 Surah 16. An-Nahl (71) (Part-14) There is a Sign and a Blessing in Matters of People's Livelihood Allah explains to the idolaters the ignorance and disbelief involved in their claim that Allah has partners while also admitting that these partners are His servants. In their Talbiyah¹¹¹ for Hajj, they used to say, "Here I am, there are no partners for You except Your own partner, You own him and everything he owns." Allah says, denouncing them: You would not accept for your servant to have an equal share in your wealth, so how is it that Allah would accept His servant to be His equal in divinity and glory? As Allah says elsewhere: 'f-i »7" *>.V 4He sets forth a parable for you from yourselves : Do you have partners among those whom your right hands possess (i.e. your servant) to share as equals in the wealth We have granted you, those whom you fear as you fear each other?} (30 :28) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas mentioned this Ayah, saying, "Allah is saying - "If they did not want their servant to have a share with them in their wealth and wives, how can My servant have a share with Me in My power?' Thus Allah says: *1' il^d} 4Do they then deny the favor of Allah According to another report, Ibn 'Abbas said: "How can they accept for Me that which they do not accept for themselves?" Jui <ja> 4Do they then deny the favor of Allah?} meaning, they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. They denied His blessings and associated others in worship with Him. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: "Umar bin Al-Khattab wrote this letter to Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari: *Be content with your provision in this world, for the Most *** The audible supplication uttered upon the commencement of the Hajj rites, "Here I am O Allah . . ." 121 At-Tabari 17:252.

494 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Merciful has honored some of His servants over others in terms of provision as a test of both. The one who has been given plenty is being tested to see if he will give thanks to Allah and fulfill the duties which are his by virtue of his wealth..." It was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. 472. And Allah has made for you mates of your own kind, and has made for you, from your mates, sons and grandsons, and has granted you good provisions. Do they then believe in false deities and deny favor of Allah?} Among His Blessings and Signs are Mates, Children and Grandchildren Allah mentions the blessing He has bestowed upon His servant by giving them mates from among themselves, mates of their own kind. If He had given them mates of another kind, there would be no harmony, love and mercy between them. But out of His mercy He has made the Children of Adam male and female, and has made the females wives or mates for the males. Then Allah mentions that from these wives He creates children and grandchildren, one's children's children. This was the opinion of Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Zayd J Shu"bah said, narrating from Abu Bishr from Said bin Jubayr from Ibn 'Abbas: "Children and grandchildren, who are one's children and one's children's children. "2 * It was also said that this means servants and helpers, or it means sons-in-law or in-laws. I say: if we understand 4grandsons^ to refer back to wives, then it must mean children, children's children, and sons-in-law, because they are the husbands of one's daughter or the children of one's wife. M' S* fzjof} At-Tabari 17:256, 257. 121 At-Tabari 17:257.

495 Surah 16. An-Nahl (73-74) (Part-14) and has granted you good provisions.} meaning your food and drink. Then Allah denounces those who associate others in worship with the One Who bestows blessings on them: i'dpS. 4Do they then believe in false deities}, meaning idols and rivals to Allah and deny the favor of Allah?} meaning, by concealing the blessings that Allah has given them and attributing them to others. According to a Sahih Hadith, the Prophet said: /{ fii :«&^ jh 2>i Si/ «Allah will say to His servant on the Day of Resurrection, reminding him of His blessings: "Did I not give you

a wife? Did I not honor you? Did I not subject horses and camels to your use, and cause you to occupy a position of leadership and honor -> Vj (ill ufjJij ^+1 elil; V £4 V 2k %_& hi j£V(k\$2 473. And they worship others besides Allah such as do not have power to grant them any provision from the heavens or the earth nor the ability to do so.) 474. So do not give examples on behalf of Allah. Truly, Allah knows and you know not.) Denouncing the Worship of anything besides Allah Allah tells us about the Mushrikin who worship others besides Him, even though He alone is the bountiful Provider, the Creator and Sustainer, without partners or associates, but they still worship idols and make rivals for Him. He says: HI Muslim 4 .2279

Jr limits rvo iZs&VP ns, isuch as do not have J&Vui ^ upjsj rtitoi [L_>-lajjL>A^j jJ-iV IS^LLi rlljulaU power to grant them any provision from the heavens or the earth meaning, nobody can cause rain to fall, or make plants and trees grow. They cannot do these things for themselves, even if they wanted to. Thus Allah says: 4J&VJ k !A> \$\$ iSo do not give examples on behalf of Allah.) meaning, do not set up rivals to Him or describe anything as being like Him. 4ofX* V jdj "Xk. iTruly, Allah knows and you know not.) meaning, He knows and bears witness that there is no god but Him, but you are ignorant and associate others in worship with Him. i53 s »*' \U*' i'v'i i - '>%"•% * '<*' x UJjIAJJj Ujy it} AXijj iyj .^1 jJju V \xfc- yj* ibt Cj/ 475. Allah gives the example of a servant under the possession of another, he has no power of any sort, and a tnan on whom We have bestowed good provisions from Us, and he spends from that secretly and openly. Can they be equal? (By no t?ieans). All the praises and thanks are to Allah. Nay! (But) most of them know not.)

497 Surah 16. An-Nahl (76) (Part-14) The Example of the Believer and the Disbeliever, or the Idol and the True God Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "This is the example which Allah gives of the disbeliever and the believer."1 11 This was also the view of Qatadah12 ' and Ibn Jarir . 131 The servant who has no power over anything is like the disbeliever, and the one who is given good provisions and spends of them secretly and openly is like the believer. Ibn Abi Najih reported that Mujahid said: "This is an example given of the idol and the True God - can they be the same?"14 ' Once the difference between them is so clear and so obvious, no one can be unaware of it except the one who is foolish. Allah says: ii V jj 4ti jI^h} 4AU the praises and thanks are to Allah. Nay! (But) most of them know not.) & jjiu ^ j-*i yj j* 'Sy** S* ^ u-j} i yy f^Ta. 476. And Allah gives an example of two men, one of them dumb, who has no power over anything, and he is a burden on his master; whichever way he directs him, he brings no good. Is such a man equal to one wlv commands justice, and is himself on the straight path?} Another Example Mujahid said, "This also refers to idols and the True God, may He be exalted." Meaning that the idol is dumb and cannot speak or say anything, good or otherwise. It cannot do anything at all, no words, no action, it is dependent and is a burden on its master. 111 Al-Tabari 17:261. 121 Al-Tabari 17:261. Al-Tabari 17:263. Al-Tabari 17:263.

His complete power, which no one can oppose or resist, means that when He wants a thing, He only has to say to it "Be!" and it is, as Allah says: 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye. \$ (54 :50) meaning, whatever He wills happens in blinking. Thus Allah says here: 4And the matter of the Hour is not but as a twinkling of the eye, or even nearer. Truly, Allah is Able to do all things. Elsewhere, Allah says: ipz%pa 4The processes of creating you all and resurrecting you all are but like that of (the creation and resurrection of) a single person> (31 :28) Among the Favors Allah has granted

People are Hearing, Sight and the Heart Then Allah mentions His blessings to His servants in that He brought them from their mothers' wombs not knowing a thing, then He gives them hearing to recognize voices, sight to see visible things and hearts - meaning reason - whose seat, according to the correct view, is the heart, although it was also said that its seat is the brain. With his reason, a person can distinguish between what is harmful and what is beneficial. These abilities and senses develop gradually in man. The more he grows, the more his hearing, vision and reason increase, until they reach their peak. Allah has created these faculties in man to enable him to worship his Lord, so he uses all these organs, abilities and strengths to obey his Master. Al-Bukhari reported in his Sahih from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said: *لما خلق الله الإنسان جعل له سمعاً وبصيرةً وقلوباً* (J-Ki 1 ti 'Ji pt-i tijJl liU-i ciS t5r^ j-'*') (j^t* (Si*j d*U & ti>- Jt ojy U} t iljL*V ^ i(J«ii.l ij &lj. i'jljopi 2# uAllah says: "Whoever takes My friend as an enemy, has declared war on Me. My servant does not draw near to Me with anything better than his doing that which I have enjoined upon him, and My servant keeps drawing near to Me by doing Nawafil (supererogatory) deeds until I love him. And when I love him, I am his hearing with which he hears, his vision with which he sees, his hand with which he strikes and his foot with which he walks. Were he to ask Me for anything, I would give it to him, if he were to call on Me, I would respond, if he were to seek Me for refuge I would surely grant him it. I do not hesitate to do anything as I hesitate to take the soul of My believing servant, because he hates death and I hate to upset him, but it is inevitable." t 1

(J-Ki 1 ti 'Ji pt-i tijJl liU-i ciS t5r^ j-'*') (j^t* (Si*j d*U & ti>- Jt ojy U} t iljL*V ^ i(J«ii.l ij &lj. i'jljopi 2# uAllah says: "Whoever takes My friend as an enemy, has declared war on Me. My servant does not draw near to Me with anything better than his doing that which I have enjoined upon him, and My servant keeps drawing near to Me by doing Nawafil (supererogatory) deeds until I love him. And when I love him, I am his hearing with which he hears, his vision with which he sees, his hand with which he strikes and his foot with which he walks. Were he to ask Me for anything, I would give it to him, if he were to call on Me, I would respond, if he were to seek Me for refuge I would surely grant him it. I do not hesitate to do anything as I hesitate to take the soul of My believing servant, because he hates death and I hate to upset him, but it is inevitable." t 1

The meaning of the Hadith is that when a person is sincere

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3040–3069]

in his obedience towards Allah, all his deeds are done for the sake of Allah, so he only hears for the sake of Allah, he only sees for the sake of Allah - meaning he only listens to or looks at what has been allowed by Allah. He does not strike or walk except in obedience to Allah, seeking Allah's help in all of these things. Thus in some versions of the Hadith, narrated outside the Sahih, after the phrase "his foot with which he walks", there is added: *من يمشي لله يمشي* - «So through Me he hears, through Me he sees, through Me he strikes and through Me he walks . ,z| Thus Allah says: *وإني آتيتكم بالبينات وأنا صافٍ بينة* p2 ^3>p iAnd He gave you hearing, sight, and hearts that you might 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :348 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :352

give thanks .} Elsewhere, He says: *وإني آتيتكم بالبينات وأنا صافٍ بينة* 4' 2 J@3^*5 eu t'4% jZ% p?%&£& ji / /» ^/»i •» v •y A»«// o")^ j fA>i 4Sai/ if is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing and seeing, and hearts. Little thanks you give. Say: "It is He Who has created you on the earth, and to Him shall you be gathered (in the Hereafter)."} (67 :23-24) In the Subjection of the Birds in the Sky there is a Sign Then Allah tells His servants to look at the birds held (flying) in the sky, between heaven and earth, and how He has caused them to fly with their wings in the sky. They are held up only by Him, it is He Who gave them the strength to do that, subjecting the air to cany them and support them. As Allah says in Surat Al-Mulk: *ألم يعلم الذين خلقهم وأخرجهم من أعنابهم ثم أعادهم فأمرهم أن يركعون* -1. i . 2Z 4i !£ - » - 4Do they not see the birds above them, spreading their wings out and folding them in? None holds than up except the Most Gracious (Allah). Verily, He is the All-Seer of everything.} (67 :19) And here Allah says: *وإني آتيتكم بالبينات وأنا صافٍ بينة* iVerily, in this are clear signs for people who believe.} (S. Gj. 1> >3 \b\j} **!# ^ jyJ £ j3 vfcik 3L IL: £5 ££ ?*>' C—4 jiOt \$j> C>J) t^'dSy)s 480. And Allah had made your homes a place of rest for you,

and made dwellings for you out of the hides of the cattle which you find so light when you travel and when you camp; and furnishings and articles of convenience out of their wool, fur, and hair - comfort for a while.} 481 . And Allah has made shade for you out of that which He has created, and He has made places of refuge in the mountains for you, and He has made garments for you to protect you from the heat, and coats of mail to protect you from your violence. Thus does He perfect His favor for you, that you may submit yourselves to His will.} 482. Then, if they turn away, your duty (O Muhammad) is only to convey (the Message) in a clear way.} 483. They recognize the grace of Allah, yet they deny it (by worshipping others besides Allah) and most of them are disbelievers.} Homes, Furnishings and Clothing are also Blessings from Allah Allah mentions His great blessings for His servant in that He has given them homes to dwell in and protect themselves with, in which they find all kinds of benefits. He has also given them homes from the hides of cattle, i.e., leather, which are light and easy to carry on journeys and can be erected wherever they stop, whether they are traveling or are settled. Thus Allah says: (y j (y. > r 4 which t you find so light when you travel and when you camp; } U i W l y y } 4 out of their wool, fur and hair } refers to sheep, camels and goats respectively. 4 f u m i s h i n g s } meaning what you take from them, i.e., wealth. It was also said that it means articles of convenience, or clothing. The correct view is more general in meaning than this; it means that you make carpets, clothing and other things from then- wool, hair etc., which you use as wealth and for trade. Ibn

‘Abbas said: ‘Al-Athath means articles of convenience and comfort.’ * This was also the view of Mujahid, Tkrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Ad- Dahhak and Qatadah. The phrase, i f o r a w h i l e } means, until the appointed time. Shade, Places of Refuge in the Mountains, Garments and Coats of Mail are also Blessings from Allah 4 & i 3 L i L ; & % } } And Allah has made shade for you out of that which He has created, } Qatadah said: “This means trees.” * 2 £ j 3 ^ } i a n d H e h a s m a d e p l a c e s o f r e f u g e i n t h e m o u n t a i n s f o r y o u , } meaning fortresses and strongholds. 4 £ 3 ' & } i a n d H e h a s m a d e g a r m e n t s f o r y o u t o p r o t e c t y o u f r o m t h e h e a t , } meaning clothing of cotton, linen and wool. 4 j £ = A X j " J i a n d c o a t s o f m a i l t o p r o t e c t y o u f r o m y o u r v i o l e n c e . } such as shields made of layers of sheet iron, coats of mail and so on. 4 ^ * £ \$ £ } i T h u s d o e s H e p e r f e c t H i s f a v o r f o r y o u , } meaning, thus He gives you what you need to go about your business, so that this will help you to worship and obey Him. i t h a t y o u m a y s u b m i t y o u r s e l v e s t o H i s w i l l } . This is interpreted by the majority to mean submitting to Allah or becoming Muslim. m At-Tabari 17:268. At-Tabari 17:269.

J r r v n m m 3 % M £ \$ j 4 0 < Z > 3 i i f i a j £ = 4 ; ' > ! (f . 1 - i i ' r j j A l l t h e M e s s e n g e r h a s t o d o i s c o n v e y t h e M e s s a g e 4 \$ 4 > } T h e n , i f t h e y t u r n a w a y , } m e a n i n g , a f t e r t h i s d e c l a r a t i o n a n d r e m i n d e r , d o n o t w o r r y a b o u t t h e m . i ' o £ \ g i t j & i y o u r d u t y (O M u h a m m a d) i s o n l y t o c o n v e y (t h e M e s s a g e) i n a c l e a r w a y } , a n d y o u h a v e d e l i v e r e d t h e M e s s a g e t o t h e m . ' . K i f > - > 4 J l l r < " • v . K I M i T h e y r e c o g n i z e t h e g r a c e o f A l l a h , y e t t h e y d e n y i t } m e a n i n g t h e y k n o w t h a t A l l a h i s t h e O n e W h o g r a n t s t h e s e b l e s s i n g s t o t h e m , a n d t h a t H e i s B o u n t i f u l t o w a r d s t h e m , b u t t h e y s t i l l d e n y t h i s b y w o r s h i p p i n g o t h e r s b e s i d e s H i m a n d t h i n k i n g t h a t t h e i r h e l p a n d p r o v i s i o n s c o m e f r o m o t h e r s b e s i d e s H i m . 4 S # 3 i a n d m o s t o f t h e m a r e d i s b e l i e v e r s . } S ' . . ' ' > ' • > > ' . 1 . > 9 > S I • K \ r ! - A p - * X * o y * l \$ o t p j g j r « p d u \$ c 4 i i j j & l © B ^ j . [# C T 4 3 j £ i j l i i i j / & " * j t i j i S ' " " l i g * J - i - j . s t i l t < i t j l i ^ i t j

/ % > > > > < y < • * ' * > " • C * S ' * - 5 // • 4 S 4 . A n d o n t h e D a y w h e n W e r e s u r r e c t a w i t n e s s f r o m e a c h n a t i o n , t h e n t h o s e w h o d i s b e l i e v e w i l l n o t b e g i v e n l e a v e , n o r w i l l t h e y b e a l l o w e d (t o r e t u r n t o t h e

world) to repent and ask for Allah's forgiveness.} 85. And once those who did wrong see the torment, it will not decrease for them, nor will they be given respite. 86. And when those who associated partners with Allah see their partners, they will say: "Our Lord! These are our partners whom we used to call upon besides you." But they will throw back their statement at them (saying): "You indeed are liars!"} 487. And they will offer (their full) submission to Allah on that Day, and what they falsely invented will wander away from them.} 488. Those who disbelieved and tried to obstruct the path of Allah, for them We will add torment on top of the torment because of the corruption they spread.} The Plight of the Idolators on the Day of Judgement Allah tells us about the predicament of the idolators on the Day when they will be resurrected in the realm of the Hereafter. He will raise a witness from every nation - that is - their Prophet, to testify about their response to the Message he conveyed from Allah. 4 then, those who disbelieved will not be given leave.} meaning, they will not be allowed to offer any excuse, as Allah says: 4 That will be a Day when they do not speak. And they will not be permitted to present any excuse} (77:35-36). Hence, Allah says:

if only those who disbelieved knew (about the time) when they will not be able to protect their faces nor their backs from the Fire, and they have no help. Nay, it (the Fire) will come upon them all of a sudden and will perplex them, and they will have no power to avert it nor will they have any respite.} (21:39- 40) The gods of the Idolators will disown them at the Time when They need them most Then Allah tells us that their gods will disown them*when they need them most. He says: 4 And when those who associated partners with Allah see their partners} meaning, those whom they used to worship in this world. ' fi u ot is; it they will say: "Our Lord! These are our partners whom we used to call upon besides you." But they will throw their statements back at them (saying) : "You are indeed liars!"} i.e., those gods will say to them, "you are lying. We never commanded you to worship us." Allah says: if (*> j i «' : «J ' sy JI J. V jil ojj Cri j-J lyj} 4 Ojf ft ip&1' lip i And who is more astray than one who calls upon others besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their invocations to them? And when the people are gathered (on the Day of Resurrection), they (false deities) will become their enemies and will deny their worship,} (46:5-6) 4 And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their

508 Tafsir Ibtī Katiir worship, and become their adversaries (on the Day of Resurrection).) (19:81-82) Al-Khalil (Ibrahim) said: J&i £) i but on the Day of Resurrection, you will disown each other) [29:25] And Allah says: !£t i And it will be said (to them): "Call upon your partners") [28:64] And there are many other similar Ayat. Everything will surrender to Allah on the Day of Resurrection ihA it j» '0j) i And they will offer (their full) submission to Allah on that Day,) Qatadah and Ikrimah said: "They will humble themselves and surrender on that Day," i.e., they will all surrender to Allah, there will not be anyone who does not hear and obey. As Allah says: £J> jJj g\ i How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us!) [19:38] meaning, they will see and hear better than they have ever seen and heard before. And Allah says: 4 '- *« "j i* (*r*J*J \f-i^ H SSP J i And if you only could see when the guilty hang their heads before their Lord (saying) ; "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard.") [32:12] Al-Tabari 17:276.

4^& :j\$^} 4And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer.} [20:111) meaning, they will humble and submit themselves. 4And they will offer (their full) submission to Allah on that Day, and what they falsely invented will wander away from them.} The things that they used to worship which were sill based on fabrications and lies, will all disappear, and they will have no helper or supporter, and no one to turn to. Those among the Idolaters who corrupted Others will receive a Greater Punishment Then Allah tells us: 4Those who disbelieved and tried to obstruct the path of Allah, for them We will add torment} meaning one punishment for their disbelief and another punishment for turning others away from following the truth, as Allah says: .L (*>? 4And they prevent others from him and they themselves keep awayfrom him} [6:26] meaning they forbade others to follow him and they themselves shunned him, but: 4&Z« Vi &} 4they destroyed only themselves, while they do not realize it.} This is evidence that there will be varying levels of punishment for the disbelievers, just as there will be varying degrees of Paradise for the believers, as Allah says: 4'ofZ -JM p 4For each one there is double (torment), but you know not.}

510 Tafstr Ibn Kathir [7:38] Ujij Hy* & oi *4\$* '-V+i i| «L»j ts£> tsz<&& p, iQ, d& 489. And on the Day when lNe resurrect a witness from each nation from among themselves, and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these. And We have revealed the Book (the Qur'an) to you as an explanation ofeverything, a guidance, a mercy, and good newsfor the Muslims.} Every Prophet will bear Witness against his Nation on the Day ofResurrection Allah addressed His servant and Messenger Muhammad sg, saying: d* Iju •— (^trr4* i— s' \$ <4 }And on the Day when We resurrect a witness from each nation from among themselves, and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these.}, meaning, your Ummah. The Ayah means: remember that Day and its terrors, and the great honor and high position that Allah has bestowed upon you. This Ayah is like the Ayah with which ‘Abdullah bin Mas“ud ended when he recited to the Messenger of Allah sg from the beginning of Surat An-Nisa’. When he reached the Ayah: ft£ iti 'H '-&*} }How (will it be) then, when We bring from each nation a witness and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these?} [4:41] the Messenger of Allah jg said to him: uEnoughj Ibn Mas'ud said: “I turned to him and saw his eyes streaming with tears.” m Fath Al-BQri 8:99.

511Surah 16. An-Nahl (89) (Part-14) The Qur'an explains Everything p teaoo&& iAnd We revealed the Book (the Qur'an) to you as an explanation ofeverything,} Ibn Mastid said: “(Allah] made it clear that in this Qur'an there is complete knowledge and about everything.” 1 11 The Qur'an contains all kinds of beneficial knowledge, such as reports of what happened in the past, information about what is yet to come, what is lawful and unlawful, and what people need to know about their worldly affairs, their religion, their livelihood in this world, and their destiny in the Hereafter. 4a guidance^ means, for their hearts. 4a mercy, and good newsfor the Muslims.} Al-Awza'i said: 4tcfP te£&& Q&& 4And We have revealed the Book (the Qur'an) as an explanation ofeverything,4 meaning, with the Sunnah.(2) The is the reason why the phrase, 4CZ£\&& (££} 4And We have revealed the Book to you is mentioned immediately after the phrase, 4H3^& &rr'^ 4And We shall bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these.} the meaning - and Allah knows best - is that the One Who obligated you to convey the Book which He revealed to you, will also ask you about that on the Day of Resurrection. At-Tabari 17:269. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 : 158 .

4 .K J—j^ iThen We shall indeed question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent and We shall indeed question the Messengers. (7:6) 4So by i/owr Lord We question them all about what they did.} (15:92-92) J^e" ^^ V 'jlf "(• Jyu> j-Ljli iif iTV? 40m the Day when Allah gathers the Messengers together and says to than: "What was the response you received (to your Message)?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, indeed only You are the Knower of all that is hidden."} (5:109) And Allah says: 4^1** ^i[] Jajj Lfjji 4Verily, He Wlw obligated the Qur'an upon you (O Muhammad) will surely bring you back to the return.} [28:85) meaning, the One Who gave you the obligation of conveying the Qur'an will bring you back to Him, and your return will be on the Day of Resurrection, and He will question you about you commission of the duty He gave you. This is one of the opinions, and it presents a good understanding of it. 4#^& pL;#5 490. Verily, Allah orders justice and kindness, and giving (help) to the relatives, and He forbids immoral sins, and evil and tyranny. He admonishes you, so that perhaps you may take heed.} The Command to be Fair and Kind Allah tells us that He commands His servant to be just, i.e., fair and moderate, and that He encourages kindness and good treatment. As He says: J±. jjjj U i£iLaJ f—jX. ojj}

4And if you punish them, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted. But if you have patience with them, then it is better Jbr those who are patient (16:126) iThe recompense for an offense is an offense the like thereof; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah.} [42:40] iand wounds equal for equal. But if anyone remits the retaliation by way of charity, it shall count as atonement for him.} [5:45] And there are other Ayat which support the institution of justice in Islam, as well as encouraging a fair and generous attitude. The Command to maintain the Ties of Kinship and the prohibition of Immoral Sins, Evil and Tyranny S'i if&ij} iand giving Qielp) to relatives,} meaning that Allah is commanding us to uphold the ties of kinship, as He says: Vj is l^Cj} iAnd give the relative his due and to the poor and to the wayfarer. But do not spend wastefully in the manner of a spendthrift.} (17:26) iand He forbids immoral sins, and evil} Fahsha' refers to all things that are forbidden, and Munkar refers to those forbidden deeds that are committed openly by the one who does them. Hence Allah says elsewhere: G JL£J~#£ Ci ji> 4Say (O Muhammad): "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are the indecencies, whether committed openly

them whom He killed at Badr, then His Messenger and the believers gained the upper hand, and Allah enabled His Messenger^ to conquer Makkah, and He disgraced them and humiliated them (the disbelievers). Then Allah says: who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him?} There is no one who will be more severely punished than one who tells lies about Allah and says that Allah revealed something to him at the time when Allah did not reveal anything to him, or says, I shall reveal something like that which Allah revealed.' And there is no one who will be more severely punished than one who denies the truth when it comes to him, for the former is a fabricator and the latter is a disbeliever. Allah says: ils there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?} Then Allah says: <As far those who strive hard for Us,} meaning the Messenger^ and his Companions and those who follow him, until the Day of Resurrection, iWe will surely guide them to Our paths.} means, *We will help them to follow Our path in this world and the Hereafter.' Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that 'Abbas Al-Hamdani Abu Ahmad - one of the people of 'Akka (Palestine) - said, concerning the Ayah: ^ CLj di&j} iAs far those who strive hard for Us (in Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.}

she has spun , after it has become strong, by taking your oaths as a means of deception among yourselves when one group is more numerous than another group. Allah only tests you by this, and on the Day of Resurrection, He will certainly clarify that which used to differ over.} The Command to fulfill the Covenant This is one of the commands of Allah, to fulfill covenants, keep promises and to fulfill oaths after confirming them. Thus Allah says: AS3\$ iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them} There is no conflict between this and the Aydt. "jj} 4And do not use Allah as an excuse in your oaths} (2:224] iThat is the expiation for oaths when you have sworn. And protect your oaths.} [5:89] meaning, do not forgo your oaths without offering the penance. There is also no conflict between this Ayah (16:91) and the Hadith reported in the Two Sahths according to which the Prophet jgl said: ^iJl c_:f VJ l<4 'js*- tjjfc jrti <_J^ *-1^ V «&' jj 4llj ^l» Cj* “ 5'jj oij - j «By Allah, if Allah wills, I will not swear an oath and then realize that something else is better, but I do that which is better and find a way to free myself from the oath. According to another report he said: "and I offer penance for my oath.”i I 1 ' There is no contradiction at all between all of these texts and the Ayah under discussion here, which is: FathAl-Bari 1 1 :525 , Muslim 3 :1269

518 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them} because these are the kinds of oaths that have to do with covenants and promises, not the kind that have to do with urging oneself to do something or preventing him from doing something. Therefore Mujahid said concerning this Ayah: 4&+SZ %} iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them “The oath here refers to oaths made during Jahiliyyahfi 1] This supports the Hadth recorded by Imam Ahmad from Jubayr bin Mut'im, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: ^1 iijJ 'i £UUjl J SiS •jL- U:V| ^ 'jt •sli «There is no oath in Islam, and any oath made during the Jahiliyyah is only reinforced by Islam, This was also reported by MuslimJ3 ' The meaning is that Islam does not need oaths as they were used by the people of the Jahiliyyah-, adherence to Islam is sufficient to do away with any need for what they used to customarily give oaths for. In the Two Sahihis it was reported that Anas said: “The Messenger of Allah (^) swore the treaty of allegiance between the Muhajirin (emigrants) and the Ansar (helpers) in our house.”*4 ' This means that he established brotherhood between them, and they used to inherit from one another, until Allah abrogated that. And Allah knows best. L ii \ iVerily, Allah knows what you do.} This is a warning and a threat to those who break their oaths after confirming them. 111 At-Tabari 17:282. (2) Ahmad 4:83. * Muslim 4 :1961 ' Path Al-B&ri 4 :552 , Muslim 4 : 1960

&&U SjZ iAnd do not be like the one who undoes the thread which she has spun, after it has become strong, 'Abdullah bin Kathlr and As-Suddi said: “This was a foolish woman in Makkah. Eveiytime she spun thread and made it strong, she would undo it again.”111 Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said: “This is like the one who breaks a covenant after confirming it.”121 This view is more correct and more apparent, whether or not there was a woman in Makkah who undid her thread after spinning it. The word Ankathan could be referring back to the word translated as “undoes”, reinforcing the meaning, or it could be the predicate of the verb “to be”, meaning, do not be Ankathan, the plural of Nakth (breach, violation), from the word Nakith (perfidious). Hence after this, Allah says: 4.by taking your oaths as a means of deception among yourselves^ meaning for the purposes of cheating and tricking one another. 0U\$ Jt& & iwhen one group is more numerous than another group.} meaning, you swear an oath with some people if they are more in number than you, so that they can trust you, but when you are able to betray them you do so. Allah forbids that, by showing a case where treachery might be expected or

the path of Allah, and you will suffer a terrible punishment.> Do not break Oaths for the sake of Worldly Gain Then Allah says: iAnd do not use an oath by Allah for the purchase of little value.} meaning, do not neglect an oath sworn in the Name of Allah for the sake of this world and its attractions, for they are few, and even if the son of Adam were to gain this world and all that is in it, that which is with Allah is better for him, i.e., the reward of Allah is better for the one who puts his hope in Him, believes in Him, seeks Him and fulfills his oaths in the hope of that which Allah has promised. This is why Allah says:

523 Surah 16. An-Nahl (97) (Part-14) if you only knew. Whatever you have will be exhausted, meaning, it will come to an end and will vanish, because it is only there for a certain, limited time. iand what is with Allah will remain .} meaning, His reward for you in Paradise will remain, without interruption or end, because it is eternal and will never change nor disappear. i&XZ afXXX uX iAnd to those xvho are patient, We will certainly grant them their rewards in proportion to the best of what they used to do.} Here the Lord swears, with the Lam of affirmation, that He will reward the patient for the best of their deeds, i.e., He will forgive them for their bad deeds. i' i," a ' < -it ' "V 497. Whoever does righteous deeds - whether male or female - while he (or she) is a believer; then We will certainly give them a good life, and We will certainly grant them their rewards in proportion to the best of what they used to do.} Righteous Deeds and their Reward This is a promise from Allah to those Children of Adam, male or female, who do righteous deeds - deeds in accordance with the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Prophet with a heart that believes in Allah and His Messenger jg, while believing that these deeds are commanded and enjoined by Allah. Allah promises that He will give them a good life in this world and that He will, reward them according to the best of their deeds in the Hereafter. The good life includes feeling tranquillity in all aspects of life. It has been reported that Ibn 'Abbas and a group (of scholars) interpreted it to mean good, lawful provisions. It was reported that 'Ali bin Abi Talib interpreted as contentment. This was also the opinion of Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah and Wahb bin Munabbih. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah

525 Surah 16. An-Nahl (101-102) (Part-14) would not confuse him or stop him from thinking about and pondering over the meaning of what he reads. Hence the majority of scholars said that refuge should be sought with Allah before starting to read. iVerily, he has no power over those who believe and put their trust only in their Lord.} Ath-Thawri said: "He has no power to make them commit a sin they will not repent from." Others said: it means that he has no argument for them. Others said it is like the Ayah 4Except Your chosen servants amongst them.} [15:40] 4His power is only over those who obey/ and follow him (Shaytan),} Mujahid said: "Those who obey him." 121 Others said, "Those who take him as their protector instead of Allah." 4and those who join partners with Him.} means, those who associate others in worship with Allah. ^ .U. "if s'..' >t:t > >'{' :i jl' c-nJ -i'jj j» o;*jJ' Ejj Ah J» j ' 4101. And when We change a verse in place of another - and Allah knows best what He reveals - they (the disbelievers) say: "You (O Muhammad) are but a forger." Rather, most of them know not.} 4102. Say (O Midiammad); "Ruh-ul-Qudus has brought it (the Qur'an) down from your Lord with truth." for the conviction of those who believe, and as a guide and good news for the Muslims.} 111 At-Tabari 17:294. 121 At-Tabari 17:294.

2^2 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Idolaters' Accusation that the Prophet was a Liar since some Ayat were abrogated, and the Refutation of their Claim Allah tells us of the weak minds of the idolaters, and their

lack of faith and conviction. He explains that it is impossible for them to have faith when He has decreed that they are doomed. When they saw that some rulings had been changed by being abrogated, they said to the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) 'Yoti are but a forger') meaning one who tells lies. But Allah is the Lord Who does whatever He wills, and rules as He wants. Atid when We change a verse (of the Qur'an) in place of another) Mujahid said: this means, "We remove one and put another in its place." ' Qatadah said: this is like the Ayah: iWhatever verse We change [abrogate] or omit [the abrogated]..." (2:106). (2 ' Allah said, in response to them: \$Say: "Ruh-ul-Qudus has brought it..." meaning, Jibril, -> ifrom your Lord with truth,) meaning, with truthfulness and justice ifor the conviction of those who believe,) so that they will believe what was revealed earlier and what was revealed later, and humble themselves towards Allah. At-Jabari 17:297. At-Jabari 17:297.

o' ft ' .yii 'V\<. rfSc» #,1 «,<:' 0jl# }^&Q%'^\pLXI£\,d& JLgjUJplait^r_l» iatid as a guide and good news for the Muslims.} meaning He has made it a guide and good news to the Muslims who believe in Allah and His Messengers. U\l -&f} j^a is Ijcjy i'i)^4 ba 4103. And indeed We know that they (polythe- ists and pagans) say : "It is only a human being who teaches him." The tongue of the man they refer to is foreign , while this (the Qur'an) is (in) a clear Arabic tongue.} The Idolators' Claim that the Qur'an was taught by a Human, and the Refutation oftheir Claim Allah tells us about the idolators' lies, allegations, and slander when they claimed that this Qur'an which Muhammad (ﷺ) had recited for them, was actually taught to him by a human. They referred to a foreign (i.e., non-Arab) man who lived among them as the servant ofsome of the clans ofQuraysh and who used to sell goods by As-Safa. Maybe the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) used to sit with him sometimes and talk to him a little, but he was a foreigner who did not know much Arabic, only enough simple phrases to answer questions when he had to. So in refutation oftheir claims of fabrication, Allah said: 4S4 Jlpz la, iLij <4> jjfo s±J£\}

iThe tongue of the man they refer to is foreign, while this (the Qur'an) is a (in) clear Arabic tongue. meaning, how could it be that this Qur'an with its eloquent style and perfect meanings, which is more perfect than any Book revealed to any previously sent Prophet, have been learnt from a foreigner who hardly speaks the language? No one with the slightest amount ofcommon sensewould say such a thing. Gl %\ ^ l\} 4104. Verily, those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat (signs, or revelation), Allah will not guide them, and theirs will be a painful punishment. 4105. It is only those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat who fabricate thefalsehood, and it is they who are liars.} Allah tells us that He does not guide those who turn away from remembering Him and who are heedless of that which He revealed to His Messenger (ﷺ), those who have no intention of believing in that which he has brought from Allah. This kind of people will never be guided to faith by the signs of Allah and the Message which He sent His Messengers in this world, and they will suffer a painful and severe punishment in the Hereafter. Then Allah informs us that His Messenger (ﷺ) is not a forger nor a liar, because the one who fabricates falsehood about Allah and His Messenger is the most evil ofcreatures. 4\$ 4Verily, those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat,} Allah will not guide them, and theirs will be a painful punishment, meaning, the disbelievers and heretics who are known to the people as liars. The Messenger Muhammad (ﷺ), on the other hand, was the most honest and righteous of people, the most perfect in knowledge, deeds, faith and conviction. He was known among his people for his truthfulness and no one among them had any doubts about that - to such an extent that they always addressed him as Al- Amin (the Trustworthy)

Muhammad. Thus when Heraclius, the king of the Romans, asked Abu Sufyan about the attributes of the Messenger of Allah one of the things he said to him was.

“Did you ever accuse him of lying before he made his claim?” Abu Sufyan said, “No”. Heraclius said, “He would refrain from lying about people and then go and fabricate lies about Allah?” 4106. Whichever disbelieves in Allah after his belief - except one who was forced while his heart is at peace with the faith - but whoever opens their breasts to disbelief, on them is wrath from Allah, and theirs will be a terrible torment.} 4107. That is because they preferred the life of this world over that of the Hereafter. And Allah does not guide the people who disbelieve.} 4108. They are those upon whose hearts, hearing (ears) and sight (eyes) Allah has set a seal over. And they are the heedless!} 4109. No doubt, in the Hereafter they will be the losers.} Allah’s Wrath against the Apostate, except for the One Who is forced into Disbelief Allah tells us that He is angry with them who willingly disbelieve in Him after clearly believing in Him, who open their hearts to disbelief finding peace in that, because they understood the faith yet they still turned away from it. They will suffer severe punishment in the Hereafter, because they preferred this life to the Hereafter, and they left the faith for the sake of this world and Allah did not guide their hearts and help them to stand firm in the true religion. He put a seal on their hearts so that they would not be able to understand

what is beneficial for them, and He sealed their ears and eyes

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3069–3089]

so that they would not benefit from them. Their faculties did not help them at all, so they are unaware of what is going to happen to them.

No doubt means, it is inevitable, and no wonder that those who are like this - 4 4 in the Hereafter, they will be the losers.) meaning, they will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. ijliw jtij »>£s=»i f i except one who was forced while his heart is at peace with the faith) This is an exception in the case of one who utters statements of disbelief and verbally agrees with the Mushrikin because he is forced to do so by the beatings and abuse to which he is subjected, but his heart refuses to accept what he is saying, and he is, in reality, at peace with his faith in Allah and His Messenger \$^g. The scholars agreed that if a person is forced into disbelief, it is permissible for him to either go along with them in the interests of self-preservation, or to refuse, as Bilal did when they were inflicting all sorts of torture on him, even placing a huge rock on his chest in the intense heat and telling him to admit others as partners with Allah. He refused, saying, “Alone, Alone.” And he said, “By Allah, if I knew any word more annoying to you than this, I would say it.” May Allah be pleased with him. Similarly, when the Liar MQsaylimah asked Habib bin Zayd Al- Ansari, “Do you bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah?” He said, “Yes.” Then Musaylimah asked, “Do you bear witness that I am the messenger of Allah?” Habib said, “I do not hear you.” Musaylimah kept cutting him, piece by piece, but he remained steadfast insisting on his words. It is better and preferable for the Muslim to remain steadfast in his religion, even if that leads to him being killed, as was mentioned by Al-Hafiz Ibn ‘Asakir in his biography of ‘Abdullah bin Hudhafah Al-Sahmi, one of the Companions. He said that he

was taken prisoner by the Romans, who brought him to their king. The king said, "Become a Christian, and I will give you a share of my kingdom and my daughter in m Asad Al-Ghabah 1049.

531 Surah 16. An-Nahl (106- 109) (Part-14 marriage." 'Abdullah said: "If you were to give me all that you possess and all that Arabs possess to make me give up the religion of Muhammad jg even for an instant, I would not do it." The king said, "Then I will kill you." 'Abdullah said, "It is up to you." The king gave orders that he should be crucified, and commanded his archers to shoot near his hands and feet while ordering him to become a Christian, but he still refused. Then the king gave orders that he should be brought down, and that a big vessel made of copper be brought and heated up. Then, while 'Abdullah was watching, one of the Muslim prisoners was brought out and thrown into it, until all that was left of him was scorched bones. The king ordered him to become a Christian, but he still refused. Then he ordered that 'Abdullah be thrown into the vessel, and he was brought back to the pulley to be thrown in. 'Abdullah wept, and the king hoped that he would respond to him, so he called him, but 'Abdullah said, "I only weep because I have only one soul with which to be thrown into this vessel at this moment for the sake of Allah; I wish that I had as many souls as there are hairs on my body with which I could undergo this torture for the sake of Allah." According to some reports, the king imprisoned him and deprived him of food and drink for several days, then he sent him wine and pork, and he did not come near them. Then the king called him and asked him, "What stopped you from eating?" 'Abdullah said, "It is permissible for me (under these circumstances), but I did not want to give you the opportunity to gloat." The king said to him, "Kiss my head and I will let you go." 'Abdullah said, "And will you release all the Muslim prisoners with me?" The king said, "Yes." So 'Abdullah kissed his head and he released him and all the other Muslim prisoners he was holding. When he came back, Tjmar bin Al- Khattab said, "Every Muslim should kiss the head of 'Abdullah bin Hudhafah, and I will be the first to do so." And he stood up and kissed his head. May Allah be pleased with them both! 1 ' u dJi& t'i' / *' " \ 't Y. \ l* M < » t "A •* •< f Al-Hafiz (Ibn Hajar) mentioned this story in brief in Al-Isdbah (4641) , and attributed it to Al-Bayhaqi.

^vil? 'J £L.j- U y-a j^=> 4220. 77ie«, verily, your Lord far those who emigrated after they were put to trials and then performed Jihad, and were patient, - after this, your Lord is indeed Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4222 . (Remember) the Day when every person will come pleading far himself, and every one will be paid in fall far what he did, and they will not be dealt with unjustly.} The One who is forced to renounce Islam will be forgiven if He does Righteous Deeds afterwards This refers to another group of people who were oppressed in Makkah and whose position with their own people was weak, so they went along with them when they were tried by them. Then they managed to escape by emigrating, leaving their homeland, families and wealth behind, seeking the pleasure and forgiveness of Allah. They joined the believers and fought with them against the disbelievers, bearing hardship with patience. Allah tells them that after this, meaning after their giving in when put to the test, He will forgive them and show mercy to them when they are resurrected. i(Remember) the Day when every person will come pleading meaning making a case in his own defence. £} ifar himself.} means, no one else will plead on his behalf; not his father, not his son, nor his brother, nor his wife. / ; « ?> ^oL-c. L HyjT iand every one will be paid in fall for what he did,} meaning whatever he did, good or evil. v £>} iand they will not be dealt with unjustly.} meaning there will be no decrease in the reward for good, and no increase in the punishment for evil. They will not be dealt

<fpfi frf ^ &F [tr £> 3*p vf? tp' :pres qBqv sb 'jbsj o; paau ou poq aq pus 'ajos sbm aq 'qmpfBi^ pajajua jaAaoq/w ;i jo apisjno ajaq/vutiaAa uiojj Xbmb paqajBus Suxaq aia/w uauu apqM iCiBrqauBS ajnaas b 'ajqBjs puB pryaoBad 'amoas uaaq pnq qoiq/w 'qBjppew jo ajdoad aq; o; sjajaj ajduiBxa sxqx qBqqupijo afdnnrata aqx 4*susopSuoum 3U3m foqi 3/11/02 ui3i{t pszps }U3iiuof sif) os 'tuiif psuwp / hip jnq 'ssapsuisip Suoiuo Uiojf U3Su3SS3p\l V UtStfl 0} 3U103 SVl(3J31U '£H) i'P!P folQ } Vl{(TLfo 3Stwo -sq 'uv3f puv (juuiuvf) J3%um{ 3U13J)X3 3)SV1 1} 3pvui qpuv os -IQ}} -IY fo sxoavf siff psxusp (3}do3d si)) V 1nq '33v\ d fu303 uiojf souvpunqv ut a oi 8umoo uotsiaoud SI! ' inf33V3d puv 3X1133\$ svm a '(t{V3pp>^i) dftfs -ucnoi v fo 3jduwx3 sqi S3(u8 ifpjy puy 'lift icp?# fXr rXi thrift n yr<*l -< if ip"-'. ,|,<0'n' Crmr •*»**->l '• '< ' ' 'Vs- 'V < irf5 rjRf^ b -5\$ \yf if %&> \?< ft? 3? ? S TTftr f+\ T0 # 5P CP "9-? -iCBM ;sa;qSqs aq; ui /Cflsnfun q;iM ?fp^rr^fe !trificf? 5r=^r! TTT!f1 ' ^1?',r?rrS\$ ^>v-J<V-fr> * \cri<< q-<r(j-J ipnri /nrc== -ip^ #! r*r"»^vvor^?r<rfri<Vri v- ^ ^ ^>4" ^ 3*?5^r^2TTf^05ESj53P f' < ' !• y "o; •Vi ees (w-w) mi-zu)wh-w 9ims

4and fear}. This refers to the fact that their sense of security was replaced with fear of the Messenger of Allah sH and his Companions after they had migrated to Al-Madlnah. They feared the power and the attack of his armies, and they started to lose and face the destruction of everything that belonged to them, until Allah made it possible for His Messenger sg to conquer Makkah. This happened because of their evil deeds, their wrongdoing and their rejection of the Messenger that Allah sent to them from among themselves. He reminded them of this blessing in the Ayah: Oj 'ijr'j c> 4Indeed, Allah blessed the believers when He sent Messenger from among themselves to them.} (3:164) and, 4i£^ <£ *j3i 3 2 £C 'S -4V? jjk& 4So have Taqwd of Allah! 0 men of understanding who have believed, Allah has indeed revealed to you a reminder (this Qur'an). (And has also sent to you) a Messenger.} [65:10-1 1] and: 4Similarly (as a blessing), We have sent a Messenger to you from among you, reciting Our Aydt to you, and purifying you, and teaching you the Book (the Qur'an) and the Hikmah (i.e. Sunnah).} Until iand do not be ungrateful.} (2:151-152) Allah changed the situation of the disbelievers and made it the opposite of what it had been, so they lived in fear after being secure, they were hungry after having plenty of provisions. After the believers lived in fear, Allah granted them security, giving them ample provisions after they lived in poverty, making them rulers, governors and leaders of mankind. This is what we say about the example that was given of the people of Makkah. It was also the opinion of Al-

'Awfi and Ibn 'Abbas,111 Mujahid, Qatadah, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and Malik narrated it from Az-Zuhri as well. May Allah have mercy on them all. 4 4? 4 if ip i^M; ci if pL&z n. \ if pj '{S,O pLS\dpa & if£4 fr%£% J£3p y vi3? if£ 1\$ 4 vjS3' if£ !£\$ u£ j£ ui 4# \$ # jie 4114. So eof of the lawful and good food which Allah has provided for you. And be grateful for Allah's favor, if it is He Whom you worship. 4115. He has only forbidden dead flesh, blood, the flesh of swine, and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah. But if one is forced by necessity, without willful disobedience, nor transgressing, then, Allah is Pardoning, Most Merciful 4116. And do not describe what your tongues have lied about, saying: "This is lawful and this is forbidden," to invent lies against Allah. Verily, those who invent lies against Allah, will never succeed 4117. A passing briefenjoyment (will be theirs), but they will suffer a painful torment. The Command to eat Lawful Provisions and to be Thankful, andan Explanation ofwhat is Unlawful Allah orders His believing servants to eat the good and lawful things that He has provided, and to give thanks to Him for that, for He is the Giver and Originator of all favors. Who alone deserves to be worshipped, having no partners or associate. Then

Allah mentions what He has forbidden things which harm them in both religious and worldly affairs, i.e., dead meat, blood and the flesh of pigs. At-Tabari 17:309. At-Tabari 17:310.

and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah.) meaning, it was slaughtered with the mention of a name other than that of Allah. Nevertheless, at iBut if one is forced by necessity.) meaning, if one needs to do it, without deliberately disobeying or transgressing, then, O-& \$t iAllah is Pardoning, Most Merciful.) We have already discussed a similar Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. And to Allah be praise. Then Allah forbids us to follow the ways of the idolators who declare things to be permitted or forbidden based upon their own whims and whatever names they agree on, such as the Bahlrah (a she-camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it), the Sa'ibah (a she-camel let loose for free pasture for their false gods, idols, etc., and nothing was allowed to be carried on it), the Wasflah (a she- camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a she- camel at its first delivery and then again gives birth to a she- camel at its second delivery) and the Ham (a stallion camel freed from work for the sake of their idols, after it had finished a number of acts of copulation assigned for it), and so on. All of these were laws and customs that were invented during jdhUiyyah. Then Allah says: fd& ui pLJ JUQ \&%))And do not describe what your tongues have lied about, saying: "This is lawful and this is forbidden," to invent lies against Allah.) This includes everyone who comes up with an innovation (Bid'ah) for which he has no evidence from the SharVah, or whoever declares something lawful that Allah has forbidden, or whoever declares something unlawful that Allah has permitted, only because it suits his opinions or whim to do so.

{describe what . meaning, do not speak lies because of what your tongues put forth. Then Allah warns against that by saying: {Verily, those who invent lies against Allah, will never succeed meaning, either in this world or the Hereafter. As for this world, it is transient pleasure, and in the Hereafter, theirs will be a severe punishment, as Allah says: {We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We will drive them into an unrelenting punishment. (31:24) Mi !\$6-c^ v&i' ^ {Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then to Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they disbelievedf (10:69-70) ->'•*? ft s"\"' •> '.!A. x|yo Uj di* mj) U yil* £/M\ jJpjy »iU'i Juu ot j>*Lj Jr *£S\ ijL* d! IjVpJjildij “0»i ,>* ilijj uj {118. And for those who are Jews, We have forbidden such things as We have mentioned to you beforeP And We did not wrong them, but they wronged themselves\$ {119. Then, your Lord for those who did evil out of ignorance and afterward repent and do righteous deeds - verily, after that, your Lord is Pardoning, Most Mercifiilf 111 See Al-An'dm 6:146.

Some Good Things were Forbidden for the Jews After mentioning that He has forbidden us to eat dead meat, blood, the flesh of swine, and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, and after making allowances for cases of necessity - which is part of making things easy for this Ummah, because Allah desires ease for us, not hardship - Allah then mentions what He forbade for the Jews in their laws before they were abrogated, and the restrictions, limitations and difficulties involved therein. He tells us: iiUU l, U dfj} iAndfor those who are Jews, We haveforbidden such things as We have mentioned to you before.} meaning in Surat Al-An'am, where Allah says: rt?* 'jijiS &f} 4A«d unto those who are Jews, We forbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs} Until, 4We are indeed truthful} [6:146]

Hence Allah says here: 4And We did «of wrong them,} meaning, in the restrictions thatWe imposed upon them. i'oAZ ibut they wronged themselves.} meaning, they deserved that. This is like the Ayah \$ (31 rpk £»j»- Ci/J' Si ,Because of the wrong committed of those who were Jews, We prohibited certain good foods which had been lawful for them - and (also)for their hindering manyfrom Allah's way.} (4:160)

Allah, a Hanif (monotheist), and he was not one of the idolaters.} 4121. (He was) thankful for His favors. He (Allah) chose him and guided him to a straight path.} 4122. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.} 4123. Then, We have sent the revelation to you: "Follow the religion of Ibrahim (he was a) Hanif, and he was not one of the idolaters."} The Khalil (Close Friend) ofAllah Allah praises His servant, Messenger and close friend Ibrahim, the Imam of the Hanifs the father of the Prophets, and Allah declares Ibrahim's innocence of the idolaters, Jews or Christians. Allah says: A&&& \$»> 4Verily, Ibrahim was (himself) ah Ummah, obedient to Allah, a ; Hanif (monotheist)} Ummah here means the leader who is followed. Qanit (obedient to Allah) means humble and obedient. Hanifmeans one who deliberately steers clear of Shirk in favor of Tawhid. Hence Allah says: 4!6&U£3fr 4and he was not one of the idolaters.} Mujahid said: "Ummah [here] means that he was a nation on his own." 4m 4(He was) thankful for Hisfavors.} means, he gave thanks for the blessings that Allah gave him. As Allah says: 4And ofIbrahim the one who fulfilled.^(53:37) which means that he did everything that Allah commanded him to do.

542 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr iHe (Allah) chose him^ means. He selected him, as Allah says : 4 'h Oi iAnd before, We indeed gave Ibrahim his integrity, and We were indeed most knowledgeable about /iim>(2 1:51). Then Allah says: fire iand guided him to a straight path.} which means to worship Allah alone, without partners or associate, in the manner that He prescribed and which pleases Him. i^i*- Oa? 4 iAnd We gave him good in this world,} meaning, *We granted him all that a believer may require for a good and complete life in this world.' ' iyf 4 iand in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.} Concerning the Ayah: iki Giit 4£20 iAnd We gave him good in this world,} Mujahid said: "This means a truthful tongue." iThen, We have sent the revelation to you: "Follow the religion ofIbrahim (he was a) Hanif...} meaning, 'because of his perfection, greatness, and the soundness of his Tawhid and his way, We revealed to you, O Seal of the Messengers and Leader of the Prophets jg,' iFollow the religion of Ibrahim (lie was a) Hanif and he was not of the idolaters.} This is like the Ayah in Surat Al-An'am:

ir? 'ylr^ oil Ip ijOb* ,£51 4Say: "Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of, Ibralum, (he was a) HanTfand he was not of the idolaters. (6:161). Then Allah rebukes the Jews, .alt p-f'V u)^ 4-i Jft 4-i 4224. The Sabbath was only prescribed for those who differed concerning it, and verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day ofResurrection about what they differed over.\$ The Prescription ofthe Sabbath for the Jews There is no doubt that for every nation, Allah prescribed one day of the week for people to gather to worship Him. For this Ummah He prescribed Friday, because it is the sixth day, on which Allah completed and perfected His creation. On this day He gathered and completed His blessings for His servants. It was said that Allah prescribed this day for the Children of Israel through His Prophet Musa, but they changed it and chose Saturday because it was the day on which the Creator did not create anything, as He had completed His creation on Friday. Allah made observance of the Sabbath obligatory for them in the laws of the Tawrah (Torah),

telling them to keep the Sabbath. At the same time, He told them to follow Muhammad jg| when he was sent, and took their promises and covenant to that effect. Hence Allah says: iThe Sabbath was only prescribed Jbr those who differed concerning it,\$ Mujahid said: “They observed the Sabbath (Saturday) and ignored Friday.” 1 11 Then they continued to observe Saturday until Allah sent Isa bin Maryam. It was said that he told them m At-Tabari 17:320.

to change it to Sunday, and it was also said that he did not forsake the laws of the Tawrah except for a few rulings which were abrogated, and he continued to observe the Sabbath until he was taken up (into heaven). Afterwards, the Christians at the time of Constantine were the ones who changed it to Sunday in order to be different from the Jews, and they started to pray towards the east instead of facing the Dome (i.e., Jerusalem). And Allah knows best. It was reported in the Two Sahxhs that Abu Hurayrah heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: Ua pj llllj jy w-lfSjJl & liiOjl fy OjaAJJ\ jyZjt ‘£? ili Q Wifi Jill ^JJl ‘^‘y jUxJlj Ijlp 3 *We are the last, but we will be the first on the Day of Resurrection, even though they were given the Book before us. This is the day that Allah obligated upon them, but they differed concerning it. Allah guided us to this day, and the people observe their days after us, the Jews on the following day and the Christians on the day after that. This version was recorded by Al-Bukhari. It was reported that Abu Hurayrah and Hudhayfah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: fy. ‘ fA I liili jIS 5i’ j-i’ oJlJlj Jit! Uligh iL Jill tdill jil ja djyfVl illlill fy 0 £ JJa •liifSj i.0 II4JI *Allah let the people wlv come before us stray from Friday, so the Jews had Saturday and the Christians had Sunday. Tlien Allah brought us and guided us to Friday. So now there are Friday, Saturday and Sunday, thus they will follow us on the Day of Resurrection. We are the last of the people of this world, but will be the first on the Day of Resurrection, and will be the first to be judged, before all of creation .»|21 *** Fath Al-Bari 11 :526, Muslim 2 :586. Muslim 2:586.

545 Surah 16. An-Nahl (125) (Part-14) It was reported by Muslim. illy o) <->-1 jUii iVi-Ji o* j-“ itii 4225. Jmrite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching, and argue with them with that which is best. Truly, your Lord best knows who has strayed from His path, and He best knows those who are guided.) The Command to invite people to Allah with Wisdom and Good Preaching Allah commands His Messenger Muhammad jgg to invite the people to Allah with Hikmah (wisdom). Ibn Jarir said: ‘That is what was revealed to him from the Book and the Sunnah.” iand fair preaching) meaning, with exhortation and stories of the events that happened to people that are mentioned in the Qur an, which he is to tell them about in order to warn them of the punishment of Allah. iand argue with them with that which is best.) meaning, if any of them want to debate and argue, then let that be in the best manner, with kindness, gentleness and good speech, as Allah says elsewhere: iUk Jt sigJi >1&£ %) iAnd do not argue with the People of the Book, unless it be with that which is best, except for those who purposefully do wrong.) [29:46J Allah commanded him to speak gently, as He commanded Musa and Hariln to do when he sent them to Pharaoh, as He said: IM 0&v ’a ‘iJS) jAnd speak to him mildly, perhaps he may accept admonition At-Jabari 17:321.

546 Tafslr Ibn Kathir orfear (Allah)}{20:44). jlj ji lit, iTruly, your Lord best knows who has strayed from His path,} meaning, Allah already knows who is doomed (destined for Hell) and who is blessed (destined for Paradise). This has already been written with Him and the matter is finished, so call them to Allah, but do not exhaust yourself with regret over those who go astray, for it is not your

task to guide them. You are just a warner, and all you have to do is convey the Message, and it is He Who will bring them to account. <y <s£ y 4You cannot guide whom you love} [28:56] •- i . -r, . a '> x - r- jx+j «si o^=dj \$It is not up to you to guide them, but Allah guides whom He wills.} [2:72] ii' L>\ \L* jIS ^ sXt YJ ^-0c- ojic YJ jil Y) -iJjsi lij 4226. And if you punish them, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted. But if you have patience with them, then it is better for those who are patient.} 4227. And be patient, and your patience will not be, but by the help of Allah. And do not grieve over them, and do not be distressed by their plots.} 4128. Truly, Allah is with those who have Taqwa, and the doers of good.}l'] The Command for Equality in Punishment Allah commands justice in punishment and equity in settling the cases of rights. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that, concerning the Ayah, I 1 ' See the Tafsir of Surat At-Tawbah 9 :120

547Surah 16. An-Nahl (126-128) (Part-14 4then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted. Ibn Sirin said, "If a man among you takes something from you, then you should take something similar from him." This was also the opinion of Mujahid, Ibrahim, Al-Hasan Al- Basri, and others.*2 ' Ibn Jarir also favored this opinion. Ibn Zayd said: "They had been commanded to forgive the idolators, then some men became Muslim who were strong and powerful. They said, 'O Messenger of Allah, if only Allah would give us permission, we would sort out these dogs!' Then this Ayah was revealed, then it was latter abrogated by the command to engage in Jihad."*3' 4And be patient, and your patience will not be but by the help of Allah.} This emphasizes the command to be patient and tells us that patience cannot be acquired except by the will, help, decree . and power of Allah. Then Allah says: 4And do not grieve over them,} meaning, those who oppose you, for Allah has decreed that this should happen. 4and do not be distressed} means do not be worried or upset. 4'off^sCi \Lf} 4by their plots.} meaning; because of the efforts they are putting into opposing you and causing you harm, for Allah is protecting, helping, and supporting you, and He will cause you to prevail and defeat them. 4 V.jl'j 5\} iTruly, Allah is with those who have Taqwa, and the doers of good.} * 1 ' 'Abdur-Razzaq ' At-Tabari 17:524, 525. ' At-Tabari 17:324.

4those who have Taqwa} means, they keep away from that which is forbidden. iand the doers of good.} meaning they do deeds of obedience to Allah. These are the ones whom Allah takes care of, He gives them support, and helps them to prevail over their enemies and opponents. This is end of the Tafsir of Surat An-Nahl To Allah be praise and blessings, and peace and blessings be upon Muhammad ^ and his family and Companions.

Surah 17: Al-Isra

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3090]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Isra (Chapter - 17) Which was revealed in Makkah

The Virtues of Surat Al-Isra'

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3090–3125]

Imam Al-Hafiz Abu 'Abdullah Muhammad bin Ismail Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn Mas'ud jg said concerning Surah Bani Isra'U (i.e., Surat Al-Isra), Al-Kahf and Maryam: "They are among the earliest and most beautiful Surahs and they are my treasure." Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah said: "The Messenger of Allah used to fast until we would say, he does not want to break his fast, then he would not fast until we would say, he does not want to fast, and he used to recite Bani Isrd'U and Az-Zumar every night."² In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ^ ->5ul i'JjL\ Cfjj> i > 'If > if-' t j* i°L ""* <ie bfi, Ay~ il. Glorified be He Who took His servant for a journey by Night from Al-Masjid Al-Hardm to Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa, the neighborhood whereof We have blessed, in order that We might show him of Our Ayat. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer .] The Isra (Night Journey) Allah glorifies Himself, for His ability to do that which none but He can do, for there is no God but He and no Lord besides Him. 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:655. * Ahmad 6:189.

4Who took His servant for a journey} refers to Muhammad sE 4^} 4by Night means, in the depths of the night. ^3 ifrom Al-Masjid Al-Haram} means the Masjid in Makkah. iOtt +f3\ \} ito Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa,} means the Sacred House which is in Jerusalem, the origin of the Prophets from the time of Ibrahim Al-Khalil. The Prophets all gathered there, and he (Muhammad j§) led them in prayer in their own homeland. This indicates that he is the greatest leader of all, may the peace and blessings of All&h be upon him and upon them. 4the neighborhood whereof We have blessed} means, its agricultural produce and fruits are blessed 4in order that We might show him}, i.e., Muhammad jg 4of Our Ayat.} i.e., great signs. As Allah says:

! 41)1 (JjAj *Al-Buraq was brought to me, and it was a white animal bigger than a donkey and smaller than a mule. One stride of this creature covered a distance as far as it could see. I rode on it and it took me to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), where I tethered it at the hitching post of the Prophets. Then I entered and prayed two Rak'ahs there, and came out. Jibril brought me a vessel of wine and a vessel of milk, and I chose the milk. Jibril said: 'You have chosen the Fitrah (natural instinct).' Then I was taken up to the first heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?'

He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Adam, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the second heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw the two maternal cousins, Yahya and 'Isa, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the third heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Yusuf, who had been given the beautiful half. He welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the fourth heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Idris, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. - then (the Prophet jg) said : Allah says 4 And We raised him to a high station (19:57).

JiJr ^ J : Jrfi Jijfr £^li wliJl jUiJl J] \L_ & • 4JI Ji • Jli ?4Jl J—< jf Jij :JJ jJb : Jli J3 :JJ £j*bli jJolUl *UbJl JJ li J Iaaj ^ Cy-'y Jjjlf; tf liji J*db : J3 : Jli J Jrfi J;Jr- J ui vAS* f^Jl jIla lii liji 0 ^ii . CJj ki_«i Ai : Jli ?vjj JiJ?r Jli ?oJlJ J-ii J;Jr *^bJl jlliJl JJ 0 p ^>y 0 £ii .<?JiJ ji : Jli ?0I vi-i ji; :JJ JUAI : Jli ?iUJ J3 :JJ 3* ^L) 'J^*-«Jl O;!' JI >;. 4 3* lj[j If^Ul *11a lif lili 'j]iJ~J l 3jJ«- JJ t#i V** (J 'J! ^ 1*4 *ili* <-«jf "j^r" fji J^ o^i: iiLd u jii j{J 1434J Uii t jSuiis' U^: iij3 lihii ji& i«i33 Wj^TM** Ji A JI*j 4I1 I J»- jl>-{ Ui 3^ i03 f3i J*J J* ^3* ^ J! «&' ;J^ J^ :oii ?id JU j£>>> U : Jli JI^1 cJ-li id Sji *id/ iuiii JjUii il3 j'j ^31 : jii ijfcjj f>: jsj JSb. da J3 J! c-^j : jii*^3 jji>j oL; Ai jl) iuj jjJ V :JUi JJ >--'^' >l cJZi 1 HA>- J .A Jeu^i ^ i3 Ji g'ja ibf jl : Jlii U_l>- ^^a h>- jS : c.ia» ?cJUi li J»»*i3 ty*y iy.i (jiJ Ji <Jj^ (*Ai : Jli tbli*^! - _a..j.b] l 4ibli d£j (*J J5J 'f' J-*^ J 1 ""^**4 U : Jli j^- Llls^ Lll^ js- i£d>- i5 J-*^ jUi j_ ^JL1>- Jibi t^JLp 5^u> Oji 4 li-i 4—3vJ |»J 1^L1aJ ^ii Ainmmt 4 I^JLp C-^ I^JL^P dj J! Cjj' |J*J J! J>- djii ioi*-l3 iSb Ji3® <3)1 JJ<j Jlii idi jJ»J V klbl J^i kib^l ^LyJl 4jbli # |4 * ' , , S 4 *4< 1 1 * # / 4 tO_ ^il^ JJ O^J [Then he resumed his narrative:] «77ien I was taken up to the fifth heaven and fibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his

555 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' () (Part-15) Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Hariin, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the sixth heaven and fibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Musa, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the seventh heaven and fibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Ibrahim, who was leaning back against the Much-Frequented House (Al-Bayt Al-Ma'miir) . Every day seventy thousand angels enter it, then they never come back to it again. Then I was taken to Sidrat Al-Muntaha (the Lote tree beyond which none may pass), and its leaves were like the leaves [ears] of elephants and its fruits were like jugs, and when it was veiled with whatever it was veiled with by the command of Allah, it changed, and none of the creatures of Allah can describe it because it is so

beautiful. Then Allah revealed that which He revealed to me. He enjoined on me fifty prayers every day and night. I came down until I reached Musa, and he said, 'What did your Lord enjoin on your Ummah?' I said, 'Fifty prayers everyday and night.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce (the burden) for your Ummah, for your Ummah will not be able to do that. I tested the Children of Israel and found out how they were.' So I went back to my Lord and said, 'O Lord, reduce (the burden) for my Ummah for they will never be able to do that.' So He reduced it by five. I came back down until I met Musa and he asked me, 'What did you do?' I said, '(My Lord) reduced (my burden) by five.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce (the burden) for your Ummah.' I kept going back between my Lord and Musa, and (my Lord) reduced it by five each time, until He said, 'O Muhammad, these are five prayers every day and night, and for every prayer there is (the reward of) ten, so they are (like) fifty prayers. Whoever wants to do

556 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr something good then does not do it, one good deed will be recorded for him, and if he does it, ten good deeds will be recorded for him. Whoever wants to do something evil and does not do it, no evil deed will be recorded for him, and if he does it, one evil deed will be recorded for him.' I came down until I reached Musa, and told him about this. He said: 'Go back to your Lord and ask him to reduce (the burden) for your Ummah, for they will never be able to do that.' I had kept going back to my Lord until I felt too s/iys.' This version was also recorded by Muslim.²¹ Imam Ahmad recorded Anas saying that Al-Buraq was brought to the Prophet ﷺ on the Night of the Isra' with his saddle and reins ready for riding. The animal shied, and Jibril said to him: "Why are you doing this? By Allah, no one has ever ridden you who is more honored by Allah than him." At this, Al-Buraq started to sweat. This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said it is Gharib. Ahmad also recorded that Anas said: "The Messenger of Allah said: 'Who are these, O Jibril?' He said, 'These are those who ate the flesh of the people [i.e., backbiting] and slandered their honor. This was also recorded by Abu Dawud.⁵ Anas also said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 111 Ahmad 3:148. Muslim 1:145. At-Tirmidhi, no. 3131. 141 Ahmad 3:224. [S] Abu Dawud 4878.

'ji* *-5^ ^T*)* (ji lSj~^ i On the night when I was taken on my Night Journey (Al Isra'), I passed by Musa, who was standing, praying in his grave. This was also recorded by Muslim/²¹ The Report of Anas bin Malik from Malik bin Sa'sa'ah Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said that Malik bin Sa'sa'ah told him that the Prophet of Allah ﷺ told them about the night in which he was taken on the Night Journey (Al-Isra). He said: to! il li — j>«>J| ^ ! oS lil Jli Lojjj — i .}*••* l/ iilii Caw ' Jkif t_s jllti - Jli " iJ^ll j-j Jjij Ja>J kJ\ 5 ^ _ J~ «Wlri/e / was lying down in Al-Hatim (or maybe, Qatadah said, in Al-Hijr) 'someone came to me and said to his companion, 'The one who is in the middle of these three.' He came to me and opened me. I (one of the narrators) heard Qatadah say, split me - from here to here.' Qatadah said: "I said to Al-Jarud, who was beside me, What does that mean?" He said, "From the top of his chest to below his navel", and I heard him say, From his throat to below his navel'. The Prophet ﷺ said: J X # ** * f J J s * + f * + 9* • . ^ o-Jli — Jli — Lr^ (J pi *He took out my heart and brought a golden vessel filled with faith and wisdom. He washed my heart then filled it up and put it back, then a white animal was brought to me that was smaller than a mule and larger than a

donkey .n Al-JarOd said, Was this Al-Burdq, O Abu Hamzah?' He said, *Yes, and its stride covered a distance as far as it could see.'

The Prophet jg said: Ahmad 3:120. 121 Muslim 2375.

uijJi »UiJi (.^Ui *Lii- iijrr jii>;ii dp j\ :JJ i-uA» : jli ?di* :JJ : Jli ?lJu^ 0 _ ~ j*-dj *i Jti» j>~ i jli Vdj J->j{ ji c-dJ tdi- jJLi fST il^l iJLi : jli ifSLUl di ffl l*i liii c..^U Uli iai - JU i^ukll ^lj jJLiJl : Jli p pdUl ^ dU 2di jdi; vi-i d^u ft j:\ jii ?iLC u : ;i jj iiiLUL EliUl jjJt> jJ : Jli . y> 141>--Ij id }~*l jl ;jj i : Jli ^j*j : j_i ijjj-* : jli ?IJU ;jj li idi 0 ^jii : jli tEl>- j ll>-j« •jj 'j*j' dli ?dj dp j-d-U : jli dp jjLJ jd*id! '-i* : jlii fdiJi d* j»r?'d! d *—*?j (*j _ jli — j^ldJl ,^0lj jjLiJl L^ja "jli (J i|«d^Jl a^i oii I jlii tJLiJl jliT lfij_j li[j i^>a Jdj j!U l^ili li^i j I SjJ-. li -oJa5 fcj^ad JI^JJ l)0?U jlj^l ^ 4ajji lijj c jli SjJL-. ol^i)l_j JLi jI^alljl lifj .djl jI^ii j0»0l lil : jli l< lii ddi z)\ gj p - jii - Jli "I aws mounted upon it and Jibril brought me to the first heaven, and asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Wlw is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Adam, (fibril) said, 'This is yourfather Adam, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous son and righteous Prophet.' Then I was taken up to the fifth heaven, and (fibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and wheti I entered, I saw Harun. (fibril) said, 'This is Harun, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous brother and righteous Prophet.'

Then I was taken up to the sixth heaven, and (Jibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was I said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Musa. (Jibril) said, 'This is Musa, greet hint.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous brother and righteous Prophet.' When I passed by him, he wept, and it was\ said to him, 'Why are you weeping?' He said, 'I am weeping because a young man was sent after me and more people from his Ummah than from mine will enter Paradise.' Then I was taken up to the seventh heaven, and (Jibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad' . It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Ibrahim. (Jibril) said, 'This is Ibrahim, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returnee the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous son and righteous Prophet.' Then I was taken up to Sidrat Al-Muntaha\ wIwsefruits like the clay jugs ofHajar (a region in Arabia) and its leaves were like the ears of elephants. (Jibril) said: 'This is Sidrat Al-Muntaha.' And there were four rivers, two hiddeti and two visible. I said, 'What is this, O Jibril?' He said, 'The two hidden rivers are rivers in Paradise, and the two visible rivers are the Nile and the Euphrates.' Then I was shown Al- Bayt Al-Ma'mur.n Qatadah said: Al-Hasan told us narrating from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet^ saw Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur. Each bay seventy thousand angels enter it, then they never return from it. Then he continued to narrate the Hadith ofAnas; Zfh\ oiifc - jti - ji4, d 0 " # ' 0 " j-Jj- d - Jli - cif 5>iil ij* j 'ipy '-4'^ ~ ~ fji (3^ 'j jl : Jli ifji JS :Jli A-ii ^jJL^* jJ

- Jli - I je. £~aji oi»-y - JI> - v_j;a>oJl Jtili jjJ} J) k : Jli lf>:> :Jji ?o>{ ^ :JlIS J.y Jj i_>J >i oJlJij Juj >ll)l ai >j} JS s^_i >*J ^1»LU V Jj£l{ - Jli - iili iij Ji ^}i lit Jji^i iS*y Jj ^~*>-y 'y^ Ji £~»y >lljl o}J Ji Jlj iiii(j) :ji JSli wu>Jl j(ili *ILj Jj grjli i*>Jli»Jl JLil o»Jlij iilili :JU JI iJUj t>f iji Ji oJUj - Jli - ib^ y ^ jl iji 'fy ^Li if.j* ?) ,*-jy ^ i C-A> ?o>(13.T jji>j^ o^Jii/iui >&i oyj- Ji JI} lf>; js ;*i 4>(iji Ji dii> - ji - ik& Jofj J! «-}i : Jlii JS olji jIm oyi :o-Ui ?.£jyf jj : Jlii»I JI cJi-y vliJiiJ iui ,>il)io> Ji Jj} f>;> oiji JiJ Vid ji - Ji - ibiV Jijcii iili iL*}*Jj ^}i t^j'idi lif Jor^i> p i * f ' , tiJ* - * i< J * ' '* » "tJ i | / • J # • (c * • - f-; • <_r^ i>! y— 'fji cr-^v *-0*« ^; ,la: . V Jid jl : Jlii JS olji oyf :cJU» •d &'A >: >bjl *** >13 l fy JS olji JLib Ji :cii - Ji - idtf Juui&\ jibii i£} Jj ^-}i ij'j'idi !•••{ * . : . «** 'i'J i »?.(- ' . • { • »- »- 0_~a<l JJ .ill* ^Jb OAXJ ipJL»lj J^jl JZjj 'Jj t ^ » ,s ' , , *»£*£? jy cii>-} ce-^y «Then I was brought a vessel of wine, a vessel of milk and a vessel of honey. I chose the milk, and he [Jibril] said, 'This is the Fitrah (natural instinct) on which you and your Ummah will be.' Then the prayer was enjoined upon me, fifty prayers each day. I came down until I reached Musa, who said, 'What did your Lord enjoin upon your Ummah?' I said, 'Fifty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do fifty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your

) (Part-15) 561 Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Forty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do forty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 7 was commanded to do thirty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do thirty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten . I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Twenty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do twenty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten more. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Ten prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do ten prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and I was commanded to do five prayers every day. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Five prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do five prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' I said, 7 have asked my Lord until I feel too shy. I accept this and submit to Him.' Then a voice called out: 'My order has been decreed and I have reduced the burden on My servants .'n*11 Similar narrations were recorded in the 111 Ahmad 4:208.

562 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr Two Sahibs. The Report of Anas from Abu Dharr Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said: Abu Dharr used to tell us that the Messenger of Allah jgg said: 'fAj £_A* JivA JA tje5 v**-A (*- *2lkf (*< ' A i <w£>- A *)»- IJ i ** ' jj^} Ji^T J^ jl*—" J! Uli tlli-Jl ;lHJl JI ^ ^ii (^JLj oil

^ju : Jli ?j»-I ilu* j» : Jli iJ,^U- : JI* ?l-iiA :Jl» 5^j dill sliUi Ipk £i Uii JUi :JU ?Jl j~jf : Jlii 4jg iL^i Jli 'ip il*-» <-*l Jli^ 'i! "jLA A*J 5 apli • Jisr?l *—J* - ~ jJ'-J' jJlJl IAA ; JI^i 'A? J*^i ' }s{ j*~> JI*A A'.J 5l*jji jA 3-iiJ ^al I-La : Jli ?JLi J» A ^ 'j^ 1 <>' AJ 1 *5^*13 i^Ji jii^ #Ji j^Ji •ilj'JI jtaJl ^ ^A A ltAi J'AfA A* lib nilsN^ ij* '—i* j*Jl*<Jl i^Jl; l—*- :Jlii j OjJ* A* "Jl® «1_*q iju jii ?iii lThe roofofmy house was opened while I was in Makkah, and Jibril came down and opened my chest, then he waslted it with Zamzam water. Then he brought a vessel of gold filled with wisdom andfaith, and poured it into my chest, then he closed it up. Then he took me by the hand and took me up to the lowest heaven. When we came to the lowest heaven, Jibril said to its keeper, 'Open up!' He said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Jibril.' He said, 'Is there anyone with you?' He said, 'Yes, Muliammad is with me.' He said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' When it was opened, we went up into the first heaven, where I saw a man sitting with a multitude to his right and another to his left. When he looked to his right he smiled, and when he looked to his left, he wept. He said, 'Welcome to the righteous Prophet and the righteous son.' I said to Jibril, 'Who is this?' He l1 ' FathAl-Bari 6:348, Muslim 1 :151

said, 'This is Adam, and these multitudes to his right and left are the souls ofhis descendants. The people on his right include the people of Paradise, and the people on his left include the people ofHell, so when he looks to his right he smiles, and when he looks to his left he weeps.' Then he took me up to the second heaven .. Tlten we passed by Ibrahim, who said, 'Welcome to the righteous Prophet and the righteous son.' I said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Tins is Ibrahim . '» Az-Zuhri said: Ibn Hazm told me that Ibn 'Abbas and Abu Habbah Al-Ansari used to say: the Prophet sg narrated here - «Then I was taken up until I reached a level where I could hear the sound of the pens.” Ibn Hazm and Anas bin Malik said: the Messenger of Allah 3g said: Jv* u** i j*- jil J* &l Jli y>j> J£ <i>l jj U :JU i i^U l UJr) cJjJI jjJ i itff ty JI grjti V*y V sllLil £>-jt * Jlii i La * C-ii i y> ^1 i&(JjJj JJ £Tj\ : Jtii 4\ ' .ilii jjJ 'liil Jj^Jl N j :JlSi ojl^i iiUi c<jj ^ ^-hij J! (jj-j) :Jt^ J! (•“ ‘(/? ^ ^ 0 ' fcy** Oj-U. JI ,_/>^ Ji*ll •illJl l^l> lip 4313111 lili 4&JI «A//fl/j enjoined upon my Ummah fifty prayers. I came back with this (message) until I passed by Musa, who said, 'What did your Lord enjoin upon your Ummah?' I said, 'He enjoined fifty prayers.' Musa said, 'Go back to your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and He reduced it by half. Then I came back to Miisa and said, 'It has been reduced by half.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and it was reduced by half. I came back to him, and he said, 'Go back to

your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and He said: 'They are five but equal in reward to fifty/ farMy word does not change.' I came back to Musa and he said, 'Go back to your Lord.' I said, '7feel too shy before my Lord.' Then I was taken up until I reached Sidrat Al-Muntahd, which was veiled in indescribable colors. Then I entered Paradise, in which I saw nets ofpearls and its soil ofmuskj This version was recorded by Al-Bukhari in the Book of Prayer. He also reported in the Book of Tafsir, under the discussion of Bani IsraH (i.e., Surat Al-Isra), the Book of Hajj and the Stories of the Prophets, via different chains of narration from YQnus. Muslim recorded similar Hadiths in his Sahih in the Book of Faith.' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Shaqlq said: I said to Abu Dharr, "If I had seen the Messenger of Allah jg, I would have asked him." He said, "What would you have asked him?" He said, "I would have asked him, ifhe saw his Lord?" He said, "I did ask him that, and he said, a«lji * I jjj otj «/ saw it as light, how could I see Him?*" This is how it was narrated in the report of Imam Ahmad.12 ' Muslim recorded that 'Abdullah bin Shaqlq said that Abu Dharr said: "I

asked the Messenger of Allah jg, “Did you see your Lord?’ He said, ifa jy «(7 saw) a light, how could I see Him ‘Abdullah bin Shaqlq said: I said to Abu Dharr, “If I had seen the Messenger of Allah sg, I would have asked him.” He said, “What would you have asked him?” He said, “I would have asked him, ‘Did you see your Lord?’” Abu Dharr said, “I asked him that, and he said, *by m Fath Al-Bdri 1 : 547, 3 :576, 6 :431 , Muslim 1 :148. Ahmad 5:147. Muslim 1:161.

«/ saw light. The Report of Jabir bin Abdullah Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: ^J^ ^ JI^ <jA^ Ji? *aJ| J&j\ ufj aJUI OAaLj i^xLj! cJo J oWhen Quraysh did not believe that I had been taken on the Night journey to Bayt Al-Maqdis, I stood up in Al-Hijr and Allah displayed Bayt Al-Maqdis before me, so I told them about its features while I was looking at it.» This was also reported in the Two SahQis with different chains of narration.*31 According to Al-Bayhaqi, Ibn Shihab said: Abu Salamah bin ‘Abdur-Rahman said: Some people from Quraish went to Abu Bakr and said, “Have you heard what your companion is saying? He is claiming that he went to Bayt Al- Maqdis and came back to Makkah in one night!” Abu Bakr said, “Did he say that?” They said, “Yes.” Abu Bakr said, “Then I bear witness that if he said that, he is speaking the truth.” They said, “You believe that he went to Ash-Sh&m [Greater Syria] in one night and came back to Makkah before morning?” He said, “Yes, I believe him with regard to something even more than that. I believe him with regard to the revelation that comes to him from heaven.” Abu Salamah said, from then on Abu Bakr was known as As-Siddiq (the true believer).*4 The Report of ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “On the night when the Messenger of Allah jg was taken! on his Night Journey, he entered Paradise, in some part of which he heard a sound. He said, ‘O Jibril, what is this?’ He said, *** Muslim 1 :161 ' Ahmad 3:377. * Al-Bukhari no. 4710, Muslim no. 170 * Dal&’ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :359

This is Bilal, the Mu’adhdhin.’ When the Prophet jg came back to the people, he said, IjS j C-jfj JjD tBilal has succeeded, I saw that he will have such and such . He [the Prophet jg] was met by Musa, who welcomed him and said, 'Welcome to the Unlettered Prophet.' He was a tall, dark man with long hair coming down to his ears or above his ears. He said, “Who is this, O Jibril?” He said, This is Musa.’ Then he went on and met a venerable, distinguished old man, who welcomed him and greeted him with Salam, and all of them were greeting him. He said, “Who is this, O Jibril?” He said, This is your father Ibrahim.’ Then he looked into Hell and saw some people eating rotten meat. He said, Who are these people, O Jibril?’ He said. They are those who used to eat the flesh of the people [i.e., backbiting].’ He saw a man who was very red and dark blue, and said, Who is this, O Jibril?’ He said, This is the one who slaughtered the she-camel (of Salih).’ When the Messenger of Allah sg came to Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa, he stood up to pray, and all the Prophets gathered and prayed with him. When he finished, he was brought two cups, one on his right and one on his left, one containing milk and one containing honey. He took the milk and drank it, and the one who was carrying the cup said, 'You have chosen the Fitrah (natural instinct).’” The chain of narrators is Sahih, although they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it. Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “The Messenger of Allah jg was taken on the Night Journey to Bayt Al-Maqdis, then he came back and told them about his journey and the features of Bayt Al-Maqdis and the caravan (of Quraysh). Some people said, ‘We do not believe what Muhammad is saying,’ and they left Islam and became disbelievers. Allah destroyed them when He destroyed Abu Jahl. Abu Jahl said: ‘Muhammad is trying to scare us with the tree of Zaqqum.’” bring

some dates and butter and let us have some Zaqqum! The Prophet also saw the Dajjal in his true form, in real life, not in a dream, and he saw Isa, Musa and 111 Ahmad 1:257.

Ibrahim. The Prophet jg was asked about the Dajjal, and he said: *Jj fl Ite i&i Isf \£\s L:\i ilJUvf fit CUii &lj t [LLi] «JU- I jj jL^apf i ^Sl ^*>LU 1 <Jlc- y* ^Jyy t ^ Jio> vi li ^ Jj >1 ,Ui f^ji <£. ^i>;i Jio> ; cjiijLi olLi .ilJ JU^ : jij^- Jli tj^u 'Its “/ saw /jj'm as a tall and huge man, with a whitish complexion. One of his eyes stood out like a shining star. The hair on his head looked like the branches of a tree. And I saw 'Isa, white with airy hair and an intense gaze, of average build. I saw Musa, dark-skinned, with a lot of hair and a strong build. I looked at Ibrahim and did not see anything in him that I do not see in myself; it is as if he were your companion [meaning himself], fibril said: 'Greet your father with Salam,' so I greeted him with Salam . This was also recorded by An-Nasa'i from the Hadith of AJju Zayd Thabit bin Yazid from Hilal, who is Ibn Khabbab, * and it is a Sahih chain of narrators. Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Abu Al-'Aliyah said: “The cousin! of your Prophet jfe, Ibn 'Abbas narrated to us from the Messenger of Allah si;, he said: Allah's Messenger jg said, loijLZ JI>-jf *Its il-Ui Vljt jl'f* jj ^y*^ !Sj^ cji}8 kc. >dij yfJj\ JI JJj\ Iff f*ui& ff f^ JJyj y»J> •On the night when I was taken on the Night Journey, I saw Musa bin 'Imran, a tall, curly-haired man, as if he was from the tribe of Shanii'ah. And I saw 'Isa bin Maryam, of mediunj stature, white with a reddish complexion, with straight hair.» And he was shown Malik, the keeper of Hell, and the Dajjal, with the signs that Allah revealed to him.' He said, I Ahmad 1 :384, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 11484.

568 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr 4So be not you in doubt ofmeeting him.} [32:33] Qatadah used to interpret this to mean that the Prophet of Allah -gz met MQsa. iAnd We made it [or him] a guide to the Children of Israel [32:33] Qatadah said: “(This means) Allah made MQsa a guide for the Children of Israel.”111 Muslim reported this in his Sahih, and Al-BukhSri and Muslim recorded a shorter version from Qatadah. Imam Ahmad also recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: “The Messenger of Allah jg said: ^hisU M cJ 1 ^4A& •On the night when I was taken on the Night Journey, I woke up in Makkah the next morning having anxiety that, I knew that the people would not believe me. He kept away from people, feeling anxious and sad, then the enemy of Allah Abu Jahl passed by him and came to sit with him, saying mockingly, Is there anything new?’ The Messenger of Allah said, *Yes*. He said, What is it?’ He said, A^jA Jj» •I was taken on a Journey last night.* He said, Where to?’ He said, v^ 5 ' J> «To Bayt Al-MaqdisJ He said, Then this morning you were among us?’ He said, Dal&'il An-Nubuwwah 2:386. [i.e., Qatadah understood the pronoun to refer to MQsa , not to the Tawrah] 121 Al-Bukhari 3239, Muslim 165.

«Yes». Abu Jahl did not want to say to his face that he was lying, lest he deny saying it when he called other people to hear him, so he said: ‘Do you think that if I call your people, you will tell them about what happened?’ The Messenger of Allah jg said, «Yes.» Abu Jahl said, ‘O people of Bani Ka*b bin Lu'ay!’ People got up from where they were sitting and came to join them. Abu Jahl said, Tell your people what you told me.’ The Messenger of Allah 3^5 said: aim^ Ji» «/was taken on a Journey last night.*They said, “Where to?’ He said, “To Bayt Al-Maqdis .» They said, Then this morning you were among us?’ He said, “Yes». They began to clap their hands together and put their hands on their heads in astonishment at this “lie” - as they claimed it to be. They said, ‘Can you describe the sanctuary to us?’ Among them were some who had travelled to that land and seen the sanctuary, so the Messenger of

Allah jg said, JaA lj l_* ^3 — Jli — 4-«Jl i Jlp I cJj LJ j — Jli — Jl Jaj\ U Ij oc> — Jlip j\ — Jp jli jji r-pj (Ji>- OL^t AiJ *LIJj cJDI lit Jl jUi - Jli - jJii “f started to describe it, until I reached a point where I was not sure about some of the details, but then the sanctuary was brought close and placed near the house of‘Uqayl - or ‘Iqal - s< I could look at it and describe the details .» T I could not remember those description. The people said, for the description, by Allah he has got it right.”* 11 This recorded by An-Nasa’i and Al-Bayhaqi.*2 ‘As was 1,1 Ahmad 1:309. * An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& : 11285 , Dala’ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :363

570 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Report of‘Abdullah bin Mas‘ud Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi reported that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'Qd said: “When the Messenger of Allah \$g was taken on the Night Journey, he went as far as Sidrat Al-Muntaha, which is in the sixth heaven. Everything that ascends stops there, until it is taken from that point, and everything that comes down stops there, until it is taken from there. 4When that covered As-Sidrat Al-Muntaha which did cover it!} [53:16] Ibn Mas'ud said: “It is covered with gold butterflies. The Messenger of Allah jg was given the five prayers and the final Ayat of Surat Al-Baqarah, and forgiveness was granted for major sins to those who do not associate anything in worship with Allah.” This was recorded by Muslim in his Sahih. The Report ofAbu Hurayrah Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported in their Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah said: the Messenger ofAllah jg said: - Jli <LJ- jJrj lip V; O-yJJ ijli to Jl>*J {jA <0(5 JbL*AA — Jli t l.IU — ^1*0 {jA Axjj - Jli 1 j : Jli w *j ojJj aLZI uij jl — ijhu!\ J~b .Oj I i.oij L^j(JL>- Jj j^ijl oJb^f jl vlljl uf — 'i «Wlien / iwas taken on the Night Journey, I met MiisaJ He described him as a man - I think he said - a curly-haired man, as ifhe were from the tribe of Shanu’ah. *And I met 7sfl.» And the Prophet ig described him as being of average height, with a reddish complexion, as if he had just come out of the bath. »And I met Ibrahim, and I am the one who resembles him most among his children. I was brought two vessels, one containing milk and the other containing wine. It was said to me, ‘Take whichever one you want.’ So I took the

milk and drank it, and it was said to me, ‘You have been guided to the Fitrah - or - You have chosen the Fitrah. If you had chosen the wine, your Ummah woidd have gone astray.V’hl They also recorded it with another chain of narrators. Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: “The Messenger of Allah said: Vti 0* iji ‘iS^r-* h* ij^—” ijri i>ri^ La aJl Jaj\ JjJl 4)1 aiy ilaS alia La [aj^£] i Crf^ ij? ,jriL ->»J ‘Aa ^ pO* .ji 1 JI>-j * Alts -u>- J>-j lip ‘J-ia pjli JU’ Jljis ^ oi *j> * ^ d’}\ Juj Lai* S^A-aiJI OJL>J - a_i ^ju ~ aj LjLi ^01 >0yi aJl o-aJU [aJ p.!\-»] jjli- kliJLa Li£ jLL>u la :Jjli JI> c-i-fi Y’AUL Jfid «/ remember being in Al-Hijr, and the Quraysh were asking me about my Night Journey. They asked me things about Bayt Al- Maqdis that I was not sure of, and I felt more anxious and stressed then than I have ever felt. Then Allah raised up Bayt Al-Maqdis far me to see, and there was nothing they asked me about but I told them about it. And I remember being in a gathering of the Prophets. Musa was standing there praying, and he was a man with curly hair, as ifhe were one of the men of Shanxi’ah. I saw ‘Isa bin Maryam standing there praying, and the one who most resembles him is ‘Urwah bin Mas’iia Ath-Thaqafi . And I saw Ibrahim standing tlxere praying, and the one who most resembles him is your companion (meaning himself). Then the time far prayer came, and 1 led them in prayer. \Nhen I finished, a voice said, ‘O Muhammad, this is Malik, the keeper of Hell,’ so I turned to him, and he greeted me first .n”*21 l 1 ' Fafh Al-Bari 6 :493 , Muslim 1:154. 121 Muslim 1 :156.

be Allah) are spoken in the case of serious matters. If it had been a dream, it would have been a significant matter and would not have

574 Tafsir Ibn Kathir been so astounding; the disbelievers of the Quraysh would not have hastened to label him a liar and the group of people who had become Muslims would not have deserted the faith. The word 'Abd (servant) refers to both soul and body. Allah says: "A £\$) 4took His servant for a Journey by Night) and: 4oM ^&& j*K 4And We made not the vision which we showed you but a trial for mankind) [17:60] Ibn 'Abbas said: "This is the vision that the Messenger of Allah M saw with his own eyes during the Journey by Night, and the cursed tree is the tree of Zaqqum." This was recorded by Al- BukhariJ Allah said: 4The sight (of Prophet Muhammad jfe) turned not aside (right or left), nor it transgressed beyond the limit (ordained for it))(53:17) Sight (Al-Basi) is a physical faculty, not a spiritual one, and he was carried on Al-Buraq, a shining white animal. This too indicates a physical journey, because the soul does not need a means of transportation of this nature. And Allah knows best. An Interesting Story In his book Dala'il An-Nubuwwah, Al-Hafiz Abu Nu'aym Al- Isbahani recorded via Muhammad bin TJmar Al-Waqidi who said: Malik bin Abi Ar-Rijjal told me from 'Amr bin 'Abdullah that Muhammad bin Kah Al-Qurazi said: "The Messenger of Allah sent Dihyah bin Khalifah to Caesar." He mentioned how he came to him, and described an incident that showed how wise Caesar was. He sent for the Arab merchants who were in Syria and Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb and his companions were brought to him. He asked them the well- known questions that were recorded by Al- Bukhari and Muslim, as we shall discuss below, and Abu Sufyan tried hard to give the impression that this was an insignificant issue. [The m Fath Al-Bdri 8 :250 .

narrator) said that Abu Sufyan (later) said: "By Allah, nothing stopped me from saying something to Heraclius to make him despise (Muhammad) but the fact that I did not want to tell a lie that would later be found out, and he would never believe me again after that. Then I told him about the night on which he was taken on the Night Journey. I said: 'O King, shall I not tell you of something from which you will know that he is lying?' He said, "What is it?" I said: 'He claims that he went out of our land, the land of Al-Haram, in one night, and came to your sanctuary in Jerusalem, then came back to us the same night, before morning came.' The Patriarch of Jerusalem was there, standing next to Caesar. The Patriarch of Jerusalem said: 'I know that night.' Caesar looked at him and said, 'How do you know about this?' He said, 'I never used to sleep at night until I closed the doors of the sanctuary. On that night I closed all the doors except for one, which I could not manage to close. I asked my workers and others who were with me to help me deal with it, but we could not move it. It was like trying to move a mountain. So I called the carpenters, and they looked at it and said: The lintel and some part of the structure has fallen onto it. We cannot move it until morning, when we will be able to see what the problem is. So I went back and left the two doors open. The next morning I went back, and saw that the stone at the corner of the sanctuary had a hole in it, and there were traces of an animal having been tethered there. I said to my companions: This door has not been closed last night except for a Prophet, who prayed last night in sanctuary. '"And he mentioned the rest of the Hadith. In his book At-Tanwir fi Mawlid As-Siraj Al-Munir, Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Khattab TJmar bin Dihyah mentioned the Hadith of the / srd* narrated from Anas, and spoke well about it, then he said: "The reports of the Hadith of the Isra' reach the level) of Mutawatir. They were narrated from Umar bin Al-Khattab, 'Ali, Ibn Mas'ud, Abu Dharr, Malik bin Sa'sa'ah, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Said, Ibn 'Abbas, Shaddad bin Aws, Ubayy bin Ka*b,

‘Abdur-Rahman bin Qarat, Abu Habbah Al-Ansari, Abu Layla Al-Ansari, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr, Jabir, Hudhayfah, Buraydah, Abu Ayyub, Abu Umamah, Samurah bin Jundub, Abu |A1- Hamra’, Suhayb Ar-Rumi, Umm Hani’, and ‘A’ishah and ‘Asma’, the daughters of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be oyr

4for the Children of Israel (saying) : "Take none . means, lest they should take, 4"... other than Me as (your) Wakil means, *you have no protector, supporter or god besides Me,’ because Allah revealed to every Prophet that he should worship Him alone with no partner or associate. Then Allah says: 4%£ 40 offspring of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Nw/i^j by addressing the descendants of those who were carried in the ship with NQh there is a reminder of the blessings, as if Allah is saying: ‘O descendants of those whom We saved and carried in the ship with Nuh, follow in the footsteps of your father, 15?££ £\4 iVerily, he was a grateful servant>. ‘Remember the blessing I have granted you by sending Muhammad.’ Imam Ahmad reported that Anas bin Malik said: “The Messenger of Allah jgg said: I <1411* Jf 3)1 jj» «Allah will be pleased with His servant if, when he eats something or drinks something, he praises Allahfor it.*" This was also recorded by Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An- Nasa’i.m Malik said about Zayd bin Aslam: “He used to praise Allah in all circumstances.” In this context, Al-Bukhari mentioned the Hadith of Abu Zar‘ah narrating from Abu Hurayrah, ivho said that the Prophet jg said: jJj Ljl will be the leader of the sons of Adam on the Day of Resurrection ... 111 MusUm 4:2095, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:536, An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd

578 Tafstr Ibn Kathir He quoted the Hadith at length, and in the Hadith, the Prophet jg said: dUi ^ jS/ JI djl C-<1 kilij U !0 L>- jjiti® sJijj 0 ijjSLi Ijl* iul uThey will come to Nuh and will say, ‘O Nuh, you were the first of the Messengers sent to the people of earth, and Allah called you grateful servant, so intercede for us with your Lord.*’ And he quoted the Hadith in full. fy* ufjV> j oi-ii i-^3' 4 Ji&i xf> Jit ijLj Jja^ . Gj IjUc IILu U*jJ jcj it. Is^ ysi jyl ^ ijiJi ^ &; iij% ‘a ffcJ# “£-&^ jt &'& ^>u\$& C !(£# i£-VJ 44. And We decreedfor the Children of Israel in the Scripture: "Indeed you would do mischief in the land twice and you will become tyrants and extremely arrogant!"} 45. So, when the promise camefor the first of the two, We sent against you servants of Ours given to terrible warfare. They entered the very innermost parts ofyour homes . And it was a promise (completely) fulfilled.} 46. Then We gave you a return of victory over them. And We helped you with wealth and children and made you more numerous in manpower.} 47. (And We said): "Ifyou do good, you do goodfor your own selves, and ifyou do evil (you do it) against yourselves." Then, when the second promise came to pass, (We permitted your enemies) to disgrace yourfaces and to enter the Masjid as they had entered it before, and to destroy with utter destruction all thatfell in their hands.} 48. It may be that your Lord may show mercy unto you, but if m FathAl-Bari 6 :43 1

you return (to sins), We shall return (to Our punishment). And We have made Hell a prison for the disbelievers.} It was mentioned in the Tawrah that the Jews would spread Mischieftwice Allah tells us that He made a declaration to the Children of Israel in the Scripture, meaning that He had already told thlm in the Book which He revealed to them, that they would caijise mischief on the earth twice, and would become tyrants and extremely arrogant, meaning they would become shameless oppressors of people, Allah says: • { ££ JX 3J >vt Jll;S4 iAnd We made known this decree to him, that the root of those (sinners) was to be cut off in the early morning.^(15:66), meaning, We already told him about that and informed him of it. The First Episode of Mischiefcaused by the Jews, and their Punishment for it

404t m iSo, when the promise came for the first of the two} meaning the first of the two episodes of mischief. 4 4i' ^^ iWe sent against you servants of Ours given to terrible warfare.} 1 means, “We unleashed soldiers against you from among Our creatures who were given to terrible warfare,’ i.e., they had great strength and weapons and power. They entered the veiy innermost parts of your homes, meaning they took possession of your land and invaded the very innermost parts of ypur homes, going between and through your houses, coming and going freely with no fear of anyone. This was the promise (completely) fulfilled. I The earlier and later commentators differed over the identity of these invaders. Many Isra'iliyydt (reports from Jewish sources) were narrated about this, but I did not want to miake

The Second Episode ofMischief Then Allah says: iThen, when the second promise came to pass,} meaning, the second episode of mischief, when your enemies came again, 4(We permitted your enemies) to disgrace your faces} meaning, to humiliate you and subdue you, tidty} 4and to enter die Masjid} meaning, Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem). 4\$ ££=*} 4as they had entered it before,} when they entered the very innermost parts ofyour homes. iand to destroy} wrecking and inflicting ruin upon it. i&C} 4all that fell in their hands.} everything they could get their hands on. iwith utter destruction. It may be that your Lord may show mercy unto you} meaning that He may rid you ofthem. t 4 j£>} ibut ifyou return (to sins). We shall return (to Our punishment).} meaning, ifyou return to causing mischief, 4We shall return} means, We ‘will once again punish you in this world, along with the punishment and tormentWe save foryqu in the Hereafter.’ 4k~- fdtr uZ*~&}

582 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jr mm TAr \$ iic^taj^ruo>l*ir5l; ^ f > *A * < * > , ^*r jl^a* »y£CJ J^=3J ^>Lv2AJ J£>j (jC-IS /x ^ / •-'''* ' >'> _» . > < >•'''*'''% x.l saSiga iAnd We have made Hell a prison [Hasir] for the disbelievers.) meaning, a place of permanent detention, a prison which cannot be avoided or escaped. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Hasir here means a jail.” Mujahid said, “They will be detained in it.”121 Others said like- wise. Al-Hasan said, “Hasir means a bed of Fire.”*3 ' Qatadah said: “The Children of Israel returned to aggres- sion, so Allah sent this group against them, Muhammad jg and his companions, who made them pay the Jizyah, ' with willing submission, and feeling themselves subdued.”*5' 1^1 jvl u* fji** ijUyi]* IJCa <0c4 ^ && v «[f st;®i*f #&»./ -f" < , >* ' ./z& > ~f >irr ^9. Verily, this Qur'an guides to that which is most just and right and gives good news to those who believe, those who do righteous deeds, tluit they will have a great reward (Paradise).) 410. And that those who do not believe in the Hereafter, for m At-Tabari 17:390. ' At-Tabari 17:390. ' At-Tabari 17:390. * Jizyah : a tax levied from People of the Book (Jews and Christians) who are under the protection ofa Muslim government '5| At-Tabari 17:389.

583Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (11) (Part-15) them We have prepared a painful torment (Hell).} Praising the Qur'an Allah praises His noble Book, the Qur'an, which He revealed to His Messenger Muhammad sg. It directs people to the best and clearest ofways. igives good news to those who believe,} in it a ij£ji' } ithose who do righteous deeds,} in accordance with it, telling them 0P 3} ithat they will have a great reward,} i.e., on the Day pf Resurrection. And He tells ithose who do not believe in the Hereafter,} that iLj C/V •£} ifor them is a painfiil tormetit,} i.e. on the Day of Resurrection. As Allah says: 4... then announce to them a painful torment.} [84 :24] ill. And man invokes (Allah) for evil as he invokes (Allah) for good and man is ever hasty.} Man's Haste and Prayers against Himself Allah tells us about

man's haste and how he sometimes prays against himself or his children or his wealth, praying for something bad to happen for them, or for them to die or be destroyed, invoking curses, etc. If Allah were to answer his prayer, he would be destroyed because of it, as Allah says: A %}

584 Tafisir Ibn KathTr 4And were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil...^ [10:1 1] This is how it was interpreted by Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah. We have already discussed the Hadith: SUi Uu 41 & it Ji tj JU -I' • * ' * < "Do not pray against yourselves or your wealth, for that might coincide with a time when Allah answers prayers ,«*21 What makes the son of Adam do that is his anxiety and haste. Allah says: 4# Stf 4And man is ever hasty.) Salman Al-Farisi and Ibn 'Abbas mentioned the story of Adam, when he wanted to get up before his soul reached his feet. When his soul was breathed into him, it entered his body from his head downwards. When it reached his brain he sneezed, and said, "Al-Hamdu Lillah (praise be to Allah), and Allah said, "May your Lord have mercy on you, O Adam."When it reached his eyes, he opened them, and when it reached his body and limbs he started to stare at them in wonder. He wanted to get up before it reached his feet, but he could not. He said, "O Lord, make it happen before night comes."|31 <Ji ci iJ* liLr) jil *,K jji 412. And We have appointed the night and the day as two Ayat (signs). Then, We have obliterated the sign of the night (with darkness) while We have made the sign of the day illuminating, that you may seek bounty from your Lord, and that you may know the number of the years and to count (periods of time). And We have explained everything (in detail) with full explanation .) At-Tabari 17:393, 394. [2] Muslim 4 :2304 AMabari 17:394,395.

The NightandDay are Signs ofthe GreatPower ofAllah Allah reminds us of the great signs that He createdj including the alternation of the night and day, so that people may rest at night, and go out and earn a living, do their workj and travel during the day, and so that they may know the number of days, weeks, months and years, so they will know the appointed times for paying debts, doing acts of worship, dealing with transactions, paying rents and so on. Allah says: 4that you may seek bounty from your Lord,} meaning, in your living and travels etc. iand that you may know the number of the years and to count.} If time stood still and never changed, we would not know any of these things, as Allah says: jal J* £jt £ £\$ £ C&. jdl iflf Oj £ dl £3 \$ i *3 oo i ySH u, iSay: "Tell me! IfAllah made the night continuous for you till

the Day of Resurrection , which god besides Allah could bring

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3125–3155]

you light? Will you not then hear?" Say: "Tell me! If Allah made the day continuous for you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest? Will you not then see?" It is out of His mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek ofHis bounty - and in order that you may be grateful .} (28:71-73) lsJi 'jhj £>; ^ t£2l> 4 ~ 4Blessed be He Who has placed the big stars in the heaven, and has placed therein a great lamp (sun), and a moon giving light.

light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and to count (periods of time). Allah did not create this but in truth.} [10:5) until, iAyat for those people who keep their duty to Allah, and fear Him much.} [10:6] c-jy Jt 3* •&&:} iThey ask you about the crescent moons. Say:

"These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind and for the pilgrimage."} [2:189] £i\ ft: %Vp} iThen, We have obliterated the sign of the night (with darkness) while We have made the sign of the day illuminating,} Ibn Jurayj reported that -Abdullah bin Kathlir commented oh this Ayah: "(It means] the darkness of the night and the twilight of the day."m Ibn Jurayj reported that Mujahid said: "The sun is the sign of the day and the moon is the sign of the night. 4\$ i'i Hjrij} 4We have obliterated the sign of the night} this refers to the moon's blackness, which is how Allah has created it." 121 4And We have appointed the night and the day as two Aydt.} Ibn Abi Najih reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "By night and day, this is how Allah created them, may He be glorified."*3 y* \$^*3' (j. 'ii* j 1\$' •-0^ JLiiS&& At-Jabari 17:396. At-Tabari 17:396. At-Jabari 17:397.

413. And We have fastened every man's Ta'irah (deeds) to his neck, and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring out for him a Book which he will find wide open. 414. (It will be said to him): "Read your Book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day."} Every Person will have the Book of his Deeds with Him After mentioning time, and the deeds of the son of Adam that take place therein, Allah says: 4And We have fastened every man's Ta'irah (deeds) to his neck,} The word Ta'irah (lit. something that flies) refers to man's deeds which fly from him, as Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others said. It includes both good deeds and bad deeds, he will be forced to acknowledge them and will be rewarded or punished accordingly.' 1 ' 4'7i7.YrJ 'i— Tv , i'r-Z C»- tji A—ju 4So whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.} (99:7-8). Allah says: 4_ij jjji VJ Jji j; Lil; U jl£ jfc, £} i(Remember) that the two receivers (recording angels) receive (each human being), one sitting on the right and one on the left (to note his or her actions). Not a word does he (or she) utter but there is a watcher by him ready (to record it).} (50:17-18) 4But verily, over you (are appointed angels in charge of mankind) to watch you, Kiraman (Honorable) Kdtibin - writing down (your deeds), they know all that you do.} (82:10-12) m At-Tabari 17:398, 400.

iYou are only being requited for what you used to do.} (52:16] ^whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof.}\ [4:123] The meaning is that the deeds of the sons of Adam are preserved, whether they are great or small, and they are recorded night and day, morning and evening. iZai % yfo} iand on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring out for him a Book which he will find wide open.} meaning, *We will collect all of his deeds for him in a Book which will be given to him on the Day of Resurrection, either in his right hand, if he is one of the blessed, or in his left hand if he is one of the wretched.' iwide open} means, it will be open for him and others to read all of his deeds, from the beginning of his life until the end. fj* ^ j J _ _ i. . iOn that Day man iwill be informed of what (deeds) he sent forward, and what (deeds) he left behind. Nay! Man zwill be a witness against himself, though he may put forth his excuses.} (75:13-15) Allah says: 4:1:4^& i(It will be said to him): "Read your Book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day."} meaning, you have not been treated unjustly and nothing has been recorded against you except what you have done, because you remember everything that you have done, and no one will forget anything that he did. Everyone will be able to read his Book, whether he is literate or illiterate.

No One will have to bear the Sins of Another Allah tells us that whoever is guided and follows the truth, walking in the footsteps of the Prophet [g, he will gain the good consequences of that for himself. iAnd

whoever goes astray,} meaning from the truth, deviating from the way of guidance, he is wronging himself and will have to bear the consequences. Then Allah says: <3\$ Oi Sj%} Ot 4No one laden with burdens can bear another's burden. no one will have to bear the sins of another, and he does rji wrong anyone besides himself, as Allah says: iand if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted> [35:15] There is no contradiction between this and other Ayat iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.} [29:13] and: iand also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge.} [16:25] For those who called others to do evil will bear the sin of th sh- own deviation as well as the sin of those whom they led astray, without detracting the least amount from the burden of those people, and none of this burden shall be removed from them. This is the justice and mercy of Allah towards His servants. As Allah says: iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).}

No Punishment until a Messenger has been sent Allah tells us that out of His justice, He does not punish anyone until He has established proof against him by sending a Messenger to him, as He says: u Lib ji 1 & S- Jii- T-i'i V VH/" ^*1- gf if* ja I UJ> y 4^ @g 4Even/ time a group is cast therein, its keeper will ask: "Did no wamer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer did come to us, but we belied him and said: 'Allah never sent down anything (of revelation) ; you are only in great error.'" (67:8-9) And, (*+' tJiSj b) #- jk> f** 13^=* UM \$ ijj'i 'f4>4s {&•£> <40* \$4* JAj jifl <Amf those who disbelieved will be driven to Hell in groups, till, when they reach it, the gates thereof will be opened. And its keepers will say, "Did not the Messengers come to you from yourselves - reciting to you the verses of your Lord, and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "Yes," but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} (39:71) And, ii 'fei ifJ' ji. ijj dfy^a> 4 tfr, Ji Li j;jJii O <Therein they will cry: "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not (the evil deeds) that we used to do." (AllSh will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you . So taste you (the evil of your deeds) For the wrongdoers there is no helper."} (35:37) There are other Ayat which indicate that Allah will not make anyone enter Hell except after sending a Messenger to them.

593Surah 17. Al-Isra' (15) (Part-15 The Issue of Small Children who die Here there arises an issue over which the scholars in earlier and modern times have disagreed, may Allah have mercy on them. This is the issue of children who die when they are little, and their parents Eire disbelievers: what happens to them? By the same token, what happens to the insane, the deaf, the senile and those who die during the circumstances of Fatrah, when no Message reached them? Several Hadiths have been narrated on this topic, which I will quote here by the help and support of Allah. The First Hadithfrom Al-Aswad bin Sari' Imam Ahmad reported from Al-Aswad bin Sari' that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jfjj J»0j Jz-j »l>- 3i 40 •iJ* Ji Jz-jj uij i Ijbyldlj *14 -** 'rJ • J 'bli oU tjjj* I<*f ' bli f**) *14^ 'r'J j{ J~«4 "IsJ-ti • Jjd>j 'dl t* 'rj J »U^•j b^, p-flb- oJISU 0^ l5^i 4^*** 0—k ijbJl aThere are jour mho will present their case on the Day of Resurrection : a deafman wfw never heard anything, an insane man, a very old and senile man, and a man who died during the Fatrah. As for the deaf man, he will say, "O Lord, Islam came but I never heard anything." As for the insane man, he will say, "O Lord, Islam came and the young boys were throwing camel dung at me." As for the senile man, he will say, "O Lord, Islam came and I did not understand anything." As for the one who died during the Fatrah, he will say, "O Lord, no Messenger from You came to me." Allah will accept their pledge of obedience to Him, then He will

send word to them that they should enter the Fire. By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, if they enter it, it will be cool and safe for them.» There is a similar report with a chain from Qatadah from Al-Hasan from Abu Rafi' from Abu Hurayrah, but at the end it

says: > ' > p-J j*j \Vy «liU cJls' l^JU-S (fij «Whoever enters it will find it cool and safe, and whoever does not enter it will be dragged into it» This was also recorded by Ishaq bin Rahwayh from Mu'adh bin Hisham, 121 and by Al-Bayhaqi in Al-Vtiqad. He said: "This is a Sahih chain." It was reported by Ibn Jarir from the Hadith of Ma'mar from Hammam from Abu Hurayrah, who attributed it to the Prophet gs. Then Abu Hurayrah said: "Recite, if you wish: AAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning))."™ This was also narrated by Ma'mar from 'Abdullah bin Tawus from his father, from Abu Hurayrah, but it is Mauquf (it was not attributed directly to the Prophet jg). The Second Hculith from Abu Hurayrah He said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: & ^ j jJft J£ «Every newborn is bom in a state of Fitrah (the natural state of man), then his parents make him into a Jew or Christian or Zoroastrian, as animals produce whole animals - do you see any that is bom mutilated (with something missing)? According to one report they said: "O Messenger of Allah, what about those who die when they are little?" He said, «Allah knows best what they would have done. Ahmad 4:24. At-Tabarflni, 1 :287. AMabari 17:403. Al-Qurtubi 10:232. Al-Bukhari 1385, Muslim 2658.

Imam Ahmad reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet '•kg) as far as I know - the narrator was not sure if it was attributed to Musa - said: ij 4j'> «The children of the Muslims are in Paradise, being taken care of by IbrahimX 1] In Sahih Muslim it is reported from Iyyad bin Hammad that the Messenger of Allah jg said that Allah said: </ /iflye created My servants as HunafaP] According to another version, the wording is "as Muslims." The Third Hadxth from Samurah In his book Al-Mustakhraj 'Ala Al-Bukhari, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Barqani recorded the Hadith of 'Awf Al-A'rabi, from Abu Raja' Al-Tjardi from Samurah that the Prophet said: P ijty JS aEvery newborn is bom in a state of FitrahJ The people called out to him: "O Messenger of Allah! What about the children of the idolators" He said, «Wib uAnd the children of the idolators foo.» At-Tabarani reported that Samurah said: "We asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the children of the idolators, and he said, iThey are the servants of the people of ParadiseV5' 111 Ahmad 2 :326 , Al-Majma' 7 :219 *21 Naturally inclined towards pure monotheism or Tawhid. 131 Muslim 2865. 141 Al-Bukhari 7047. 151 Al-Mu]am Al-Kabir, 7 :244 , Al-Majma'7 :219

Meanings of Amama The commentators differed over the meaning of this word. It was said that the phrase translated here as "Amama those who live luxuriously. Then, they transgress therein" means, "We send Our decree upon them" as Allah says elsewhere: iOur decree reaches it by night or by day> For [Amama cannot mean "Our command^ because Allah does not command or enjoin immorality. Or, they said it means that Allah subjugated them to commit immoral deeds, so they deserved the punishment. Or it was said that it means: "We commanded them to obey Us, but they committed immoral sins, so they deserved punishment." This was reported from Ibn Jurayj from Ibn 'Abbas, 111 and it is also the view of Said bin Jubayr. 12' 4ft£2 ft£ iAmama those who live luxuriously. Then, they transgress therein 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: [this means] "We gave power to the evil people, so they committed sin therein (in the town), and because they did that, Allah destroyed them with the punishment." This is similar to the Ayah: iAnd thus We have set up in every town great

ones of its wicked people}13 [6:133] This was also the view of Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Mujahid and Ar- Rabi’ bin Anas.141 4ft£3 ft>’\$ 4? J 1\$ iAnd when We decide to distroy a tenon (populaton), Amama At-Tabari 17:403. 121 At-Tabari 17:403. At-Tabari 17:404. At-Tabari 17:404.

599Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (17-19) (Part-15 this world), We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have appointedfor him Hell; he will bum therein disgraced and rejected.} 419. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer, then such are the ones whose striving shall be appreciated, (rewarded by Allah).} The Reward ofThose who desire this World and Those who desire the Hereafter Allah tells us that not everyone who desires this world and its luxuries gets what he wants. That is attained by those whom Allah wants to have it, and they get what He wills that they should get. This Ayah narrows down the general statements made in other Ay&t. Allah says: 4’f+*r /J .Li j^Ji Jii U Jl \X*i-} 4We readily grant him what We will for whom We like, afterwards, We have appointedfor him Hell} meaning, in the Hereafter, 4VLU,} 4he will bum therein} means, he will enter it until it covers on all sides, idisgraced} means, blamed for his bad behaviour and deeds, because he chose the transient over the eternal, evil 4(>y£} irejected.} means, far away (from Allah's mercy), humiliated and put to shame. ft '£>} 4And whoever desires the Hereafter} wanting the Hereafter and its blessings and delights, 4££a 4and strivesfor it, with the necessary effort duefor it}

420. On each these as well as those VJe bestow from the bounties ofyour Lord. And the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden.} 4.21 . See how We prefer one above another (in this world), and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} Allah says: 4%} 40n each} meaning, on each of the two groups, those who desire this world and those who desire the Hereafter, We bestow what they want 4<&> &.}

ifrom the bounties ofyour Lord.} means, He is the One Who is in control of all things, and He is never unjust. He gives to each what he deserves, whether! it is eternal happiness or doom. His decree is unstoppable, no one can withhold what He gives or change what He wants. Allah says: iiP 3\$ scX c,} iAnd the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden .} meaning, no one can withhold or prevent them. Qatadah said, iAnd the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden.} “(It means) they can never decrease”. i&z AS 0? Cj} iAnd the Bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden} Al-Hasan and others said, “(It means) they can never be prevented.” Then Allah says: \$ zszau s?jX} iSee how We prefer one above another,} meaning in this world, so that some are rich and some are poor, and others are in between; some are beautiful, some are ugly and others are in between; some die young while others live to a great age, and some die in between. iand verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} means, the differences between them in the Hereafter will be greater than the differences between them in this world. Soihe of them will be in varying levels of Hell, in chains and fetters, while others will be in the lofty degrees of Paradise, with its blessings and delights. The people of Hell will vary in thfeir positions and levels, just as the people of Paradise will, jin m At-Tabari 17:410.

603Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (23-24) (Part-15 Allah jg said: *J 4>! J-iji jilt icili ^0L IjJili a»U oLii "J 'js. CYj Ul ^Whoever is afflicted with poverty and goes and asks people for help, will never get rid of his poverty, but ifhe asks Allah for help, then Allah will grant him the means of independence sooner or

later. » 11 This was also recorded by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Hasan Sahih Gharib”. 121 Juhi; C4j j; a.# f Z1XS 4 j - ^ oj jij ot 4-ii' u+j 423 . And your Lord has Qadd [decreed] that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents. If one of them or both of them attain old age in your life, say not to them a word of disrespect, nor reprimand them but address them in terms of honor.} 424. And lower unto them the wing of submission and humility through mercy, and say: "My Lord! Bestow on them Your mercy as they did bring me up when I was young."} The Command to Worship Allah Alone and to be Dutiful to One's Parents Allah commands us to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate. The word Qada [normally having the meaning of decree] here means “commanded”. Mujahid said that “And He has Qada” means enjoined.[3* This is also how Ubayy bin Ka*b, Ibn Mas'ud and Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim recited the Ayah as: 111 Ahmad 1 :407. Abu Dawud 2 : 296, Tuhfat al-Ahwardhi 6:617. At-Jabari 17:414.

And lower unto them the wing of submission and humility through mercy,^ means, be humble towards them in your actions. U&j ^ ilij 4 and say: “My Lord! Bestow on them Your Mercy as they did bring me up when I was young.”} means, say this when they grow old and when they die. Ibn ‘Abbas said: “But then Allah revealed: io&Q !EiLS j g£C j C} it is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah’s forgiveness for the idolaters...y^ (9:13) There are many Hadiths which speak about honoring one’s parents, such as the Hadith narrated through a number of chains of narration from Anas and others, which states that the Prophet climbed up on the Minbar, and then said, ((Amin, Amin, Amin.)) It was said, “O Messenger of Allah , why did you say Amin?” He said: :ji iwill* ail* J>-j wii jJm U : Jlii Jijl^- p-k qp- j*! oLjlaj aIL* jiS J>-j :Ju ^ :cJla» \$ tyfA J>-j wif :Jli p t-lfA : ji iH ‘fou •j-jl : W. l.ai ij-aT :ji jUi ‘ifriZ came to me and said, “O Muhammad, he is doomed who hears you mentioned and does not say Salla upon you.” He said, "Say Amin," so I said Amin. Then he said, "He is doomed who sees the month of Ramadan come and go, and he has not been forgiven." He said, "Say Amin," so I said Amin. Then he said, "He is doomed who grows up and both his parents or one of them are still alive, and they do not cause him to enter Paradise." He said, "Say Amin," so I said Amin.»[21 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet M said: At-Tabari 17:421. Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 5 :550

606 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir Jlip [U*J] iijy} ifaJ '•^1 j*^ gS1*JI J>-j Jj »He is doomed, he is doomed, he is doomed, the man whose parents, one or both of them, reach old age while he is alive and he does not enter ParadiseJ This version is Sahih although no one recorded it other than Muslim.*2’ Another Hadith• Imam Ahmad recorded Mu'awiyah bin Jahimah As-Salami saying that Jahimah came to the Prophet Si and said: “O Messenger of Allah, I want to go out to fight and I have come to seek your advice.” He said, •ftU ju& *Do you have a mother?• He said, “Yes.” The Prophet Si said, alfcUj j4 2*3l i#iu» «77jcti stay with her, for Paradise is at her feet. Similar incidents were also recorded by others.’3 ’ This was recorded by An-Nasa’i and Ibn Majah.’4’ Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Miqdam bin Ma’dikarib said that the Prophet Si said: 01 OJ ^ 411I (jl |^tlj Sill Oj® >_jyS/L 'pSL-fjj 4ul jl jj eAllah enjoins you concerning your fathers, Allah enjoins you concerning your mothers, Allah enjoins you concerning your mothers, Allah enjoins you concerning your mothers, Allah 111 Ahmad 2:346. [2> Muslim 4:1978. ,3> Ahmad 3:429. [4 ’ An-Nasal 6 : 1 1 , Ibn Majah 2 :930

607 Surah 17. Al-Isra' (25) (Part-15) enjoins you concerning your close relatives then the next in closeness.® This was recorded by Ibn Majah from the Hadith of 'Abdullah bin 'Ayyash.*2 Another Hadith Ahmad recorded that a man from Banu Yaru' said: "I came to the Prophet m, while he was talking to the people, and I heard him saying, •illist iluit liililj kluf i Hill)Jk>LaJ l 1The hand of the one who gives is superior. (Give to) your mother and your father, your sister and your brother, then the closest and next closest .»"*3 i25. Your Lord knows best what is in your souls. If you are righteous, then, verily, He is Ever Most Forgiving to those who turn to Him in repentance. Omissions committed against Parents are pardoned with Good Relations and Repentance Said bin Jubayr said: "This refers to a man who said something that he did not think would be offensive to his parents." According to another report: "He did not mean anything bad by that."141 So Allah said: ji jCji 4C -Off} iYour Lord knows best what is in your souls. If you are righteous,} iHe is Ever Most Forgiving to those who turn to Him in repentance.} I 1 * Ahmad 4:132. Ibn Majah 2:1207. * Ahmad 4 :64 At-Jabari 17:422.

608 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Qatadah said: "To the obedient who pray." iHe is Ever Most Forgiving to those who turn to Him in repentance.} Shuhah narrated from Yahya bin Said from Said bin Al- Musayyib; "This refers to those who commit sin then repent, and commit sin then repent."*21 'Ata' bin Yasar, Said bin Jubayr and Mujahid said: "They are the ones who return to goodness."*3 * Mujahid narrated from TJBayd bin TJmayr, concerning this Ayah: "This is the one who, when he remembers his sin when he is alone, he seeks the forgiveness of Allah." Mujahid agreed with him on that.*4 Ibn Jarir said: "The best view on this matter is of those who said that it refers to the one who repents after committing sin, who comes back from disobedience to obedience and who leaves that which Allah hates for that which He loves and is pleased with."*5 * What he said is correct, for Allah says, in iVerily, to Us will be their return} (88:25). And according to a SahQi Hadlth, the Messenger of Allah would say when he returned from a journey, "I've have returned repenting, worshipping and praising our Lord.**6' jjJ Hj c^> &^4 os& ^ as At-Tabari 17:422. * At-Tabari 17:423. At-Tabari 17:424, 425. * At-Tabari 17:424. * At-Tabari 17:425. 161 FathAl-Bdri3:724.

609 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (26-28) (Part-15) i26. And give to the kinsman his due, and to the Miskin (poor), and to the wayfarer. But spend not wastefully (your wealth) in the manner of a spendthrift> 427. Verily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the ShayatTn (devils), and the Slwytan is ever ungrateful to his Lord.\$ i28. And if you turn away from them and you are awaiting a mercy from your Lord far which you hope, then, speak unto them a soft, kind word The Command to maintain the Ties of Kinship and the Prohibition of Extravagance When Allah mentions honoring one's parents, He follows this with the command to treat one's relatives well and to maintain the ties of kinship. According to the Hadith: P* Jj p c iituj "Your mother and your father, then your closest relatives and the next closest .»(1 According to another Hadith: .jj d iijj J> il a*' ^Whoever would like to see his provision expanded and his life extended, let him maintain his ties of kinship .» <<&&u iBut spend not wastefully (your wealth) in the manner of a spendthrift When Allah commands spending, He forbids extravagance, Spending should be moderate, as stated in another Ayah: pj P 4And those wfw, when they spend, are neither extravagant nor stingy». [25:67] Then He says, to discourage extravagance: -.Sh [21 Ahmad 2 :226 Muslim 4 :1982.

iVerily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the Shaydtin,) They have this trait in common. Ibn Mas'ud said: "This refers spending extravagantly when it is not appropriate."111 Ibn 'Abb&s said likewise . 121

Mujahid said: "If a man spends all his wealth on appropriate things, then he is not a spendthrift, but if he spends a little inappropriately, then he is a spendthrift."131 Qatadah said: "Extravagance means spending money on sin in disobeying Allah, and on wrongful and corrupt things."141 Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said: "A man came from Banu Tamim to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and said: 'O Messenger of Allah, I have a lot of wealth, I have a family, children, and the refinements of city life, so tell me how I should spend and what I should do.' The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Pay the Zakah on your wealth if any is due, for it is purification that will make you pure, maintain your ties of kinship, pay attention to the rights of beggars, neighbors and the poor.' He said: 'O Messenger of Allah, make it less for me.' He [recited]: *And give to the kinsman his due, and to the Miskin (poor) and to the wayfarer. But spend not wastefully in the manner of a spendthrift* The man said, 'That is enough for me, O Messenger of Allah. If I pay Zakah to your messenger, will I be absolved of that duty before Allah and His Messenger?' The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Yes.' Oil *And if you give it to my messenger, you will have fulfilled it, and you will have the reward for it, and the sin is on the one who changes it.*" 111 At-Tabari 17:428. 121 At-Tabari 17:429. 131 At-Tabari 17:429. 141 At-Tabari 17:429.

611 Surah 17. Al-Isr' (29-30) (Part-15) «Yes, if you give it to my messenger, you will have fulfilled it, and you will have the reward for it, and the sin is on the one who changes it.» 11 Verily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the Shayatn, meaning, they are their brothers in extravagance, foolishness, failing to obey Allah and committing sin. Allah said: *And the Shaytan is ever ungrateful to his Lord* meaning, he is an ingrate, because he denied the blessings of Allah and did not obey Him, turning instead to disobedience and rebellion. *And if you give it to my messenger, you will have fulfilled it, and you will have the reward for it, and the sin is on the one who changes it.* And if you him away from them and you are awaiting a mercy from your Lord. If your relatives and those to whom We have commanded you to give, ask you for something, and you do not have anything, and you turn away from them because you have nothing to give, then, speak unto them a soft, kind word. meaning, with a promise. This was the opinion of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others. 29. And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck, nor overextend it (like a spendthrift), so that you become blameworthy and in severe poverty. 111 Ahmad 3:136. Some scholars consider this Hadith authentic, although it is not confirmed that its narrator, Said bin Abi Hilal, actually heard from Anas bin Malik. At-Tabari 17:431,432

430. Truly, your Lord expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (for whom He wills). Verily, He is Ever All-Knowing, All-Seer of His servants. Moderation in Spending Allah enjoins moderation in living. He condemns miserliness and forbids extravagance. *And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck,* this means, do not be miserly and stingy, never giving anything to anyone, as the Jews - may the curses of Allah be upon them - said, "Allah's Hand is tied up (i.e., He does not give and spend of His bounty)". They attributed miserliness to Him, Exalted and Sanctified be the Most Generous Bestower! *nor overextend it (like a spendthrift)* means, nor be extravagant in spending and giving more than you can afford, or paying more than you earn, lest you become blameworthy and find yourself in severe poverty. If you are a miser, people will blame you and condemn you, and no longer rely on you. When you spend more than you can afford, you will find yourself without anything to spend, so you will be worn out, like an animal that cannot walk, so it becomes weak and incapable. It is described as worn out, which is similar in meaning to exhausted. As Allah says: *Then look again: "Can you see any rifts?" Then look again and yet again,*

your sight will return to you in a state of humiliation and worn out.) (67:3-4) meaning, unable to see any faults. Similarly, Ibn ‘Abbas, Al- Hasan, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj, Ibn Zayd and others understood this Ayah as miserliness and extravagance. ' It was reported in T At-Tabari 17:434, 435.

in the Two Sahihs from the Hadith of Abu Az-Zinad from Al- A'raj that Abu Hurayrah heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: *«إن من أكل من ثمره حتى يبلغه فهو على ما بلغ»* “The parable of the miser and the almsgiver is that of two persons wearing iron cloaks from their chests to their collar-bones. When the almsgiver gives in charity, the cloak becomes spacious until it covers his whole body to such an extent that it hides his fingertips and covers his tracks (obliterates his tracks - or, his sins will be forgiven). And when the miser wants to spend, it (the iron cloak) sticks and (its) every ring gets stuck to its place, and he tries to widen it, but it does not become loose.” This version was recorded by Al-Bukhari in the Book Zakat. In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Muzarrid narrated from Said bin Yasar that Abu Hurayrah said: “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *«لا يومئذ يفرح الله بعبده حتى يعطيه من ثمنه»* “There is no day when a person wakes up but two angels come down from heaven. One of them says, ‘O Allah, compensate the one who gives (in charity),’ and the other one says, ‘O Allah, destroy the one who withholds.’” Muslim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet ﷺ said: *«ما يكثر من الدنيا إلا ينقص من الآخرة»* “Wealth never decreases because of Sadaqah (charity). Allah never increases a servant who gives in charity except in honor, and whoever is humble for the sake of Allah, Allah will raise him.” Fath Al-Bari 3 :358 , Muslim 2 :708

Prohibition of killing Children This Ayah indicates that Allah is more compassionate towards His servants than a father to his child, because He forbids killing children just as He enjoins parents to take care of their children in matters of inheritance. The people of Jahiliyyah would not allow their daughters to inherit from them, and some would even kill their daughters lest they make them more poor. Allah forbade that and said: *«ولا تقتلوا أولادكم»* “And kill not your children for fear of poverty.” meaning, lest they may make you poor in the future. This is

why Allah mentions the children’s provision first:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3155–3171]

«وعلينا أن نؤتيهم من حيث لا يحتسبون» “We shall provide for them as well as for you.” In Surat Al-An‘am, Allah says: *«ولا تقتلوا أولادكم»* “And kill not your children because of poverty.” [6:151] *«وعلينا أن نؤتيهم من حيث لا يحتسبون»* [6:151] and. *«وعلينا أن نؤتيهم من حيث لا يحتسبون»* means, a major sin. In Two Sahihs it is recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ad said: “I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, which sin is the worst?’ He said, it is *«أن يقتلوا أولادهم»* “To appoint rivals of Allah when He has created you.” I asked, Then what?” He said, *«أن يقتلوا أولادهم»* “To kill your child lest he should eat with you.” I asked, Then what?” He said, *«أن يقتلوا أولادهم»* “To commit adultery with your neighbor's wife.” 111 Fath Al-Bari 8:13.

«ولا تقربوا إلى الفواحش» “And come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is Fahishah (immoral sin) and an evil way.” The Command to avoid Zina (Unlawful Sex) and Everything that leads to it Allah says, forbidding His servants to commit Zina or to approach it or to do anything that may lead to it: *«ولا تقربوا إلى الفواحش»* “And come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is a Fahishah (immoral sin)” meaning a major

sin, iand an evil way.} meaning, a terrible way to behave. Imam Ahmad recorded Abu Umamah saying that a young man came to the Prophet sg and said, “O Messenger of Allah! Give me permission to commit Zina (unlawful sex).” The people surrounded him and rebuked him, saying, “Stop! Stop!” But

the Prophet jg said, >{ • . “Come closer The young man came to him, and he said, “Sit down « so he sat down. The Prophet jg said, “Would you like it (unlawful sex) for your mother?» He said, “No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you.” The Prophet jg said, 'Ij1 «Neither do the people like it for their mothers . » The Prophet jg said, “Would you like it for your daughter?» He said, “No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you.” The Prophet jg said,

ZjL: % «Neither do the people like it for their daughters .» The Prophet said, •Would you like it for your sister?* He said, “No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you.” The Prophet jg said, «Neither do the people like it for their sisters .» The Prophet said, *Would you like it for your paternal aunt?* He said, “No, lay Allah, O Allah’s Messenger! may I be ransomed for you.” Tne Prophet jg said, >i!ji ij 1 «Neither do the people like it for their paternal aunts.* The Prophet m, said, “Would you like it for your maternal aunt?* He said, “No, tj»y Allah, O Allah’s Messenger! may I be ransomed for you.” Tne Prophetm said, *Neither do the people like it for their maternal auntsJ Then the Prophet put his hand on him and said, ' - .1 • • - >A' . , 1V3 j&J “O Allah, forgive his sin, purify his heart and guard his chastity. After that the young man never paid attention to anything of that nature. 1 ’ * .^j) GELE JJ£ ^ j!^ ys to ifr;^ A jSK 4 -ip. ,M Ahmad 5 :256.

pleased with him, and Mu'awiyah did event- ually take power, as Ibn ‘Abbas said oin the basis of this Ayah. This is one of the stranger ofmatters, 4 •%) 4But let him not exceed limits in the matter of taking life. They said: this means the heir should not go to extremes in killing the killer, such ajs mutilating the body or taking revenge on persons other than the killer. iVerily, he is helped;} means, the heir is helped against the killer by the SharVahand by divine decree. mm tao j\Jj }j_) - psJSM^3^c0d^S i\ ipx ijt'j' jt&& * & i jc >;p sf> iPi£& ^4\% '-K Ii>jp <& 434. And come not near to the orphan's property except to improve it, until he attains the age offull strength. And fulfill (every) covenant. Verily, the covenant will be questioned about.} 435. And givefull measure when you measure, and weigh with a balance that is straight. That is good (advantageous) and better in the end.}

The Command to handle the Orphan's Wealth properly and to be Honest in Weights and Measures 4And come not near to the orphan's property except to improve it, until he attains the age offull strength .} meaning, do not dispose of the orphan’s wealth except in a proper manner. it& ibut consume it [the orphan's property] not wastefully and hastily fearing that they should grow up, and whoever (among guardians) is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable (according to his labor).} [4:6] In Sahih Muslim it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Abu Dharr: ^^ ^1j i dlji ^1 jj d •p^l <3u Yj «0 Abu Dharr, I see that you are weak (in administering), and I like for you that which I like for myself. Do not let yourself be appointed as Amir over two people, and do not let yourselfbe appointed as guardian ofan orphan's property. »* 11 4And fitlfill (every) covenant.} meaning, everything that you promise people, and the covenants that you agree to, because the person who makes a covenant or a promise will be asked about it: iVerily, the covenant will be questioned about.} m Muslim 3 :1458.

621 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (36) (Part-15) } And give full measure when you measure. } meaning, do not try to make it weigh less nor wrong people with their belongings. } and weigh with a balance } meaning scales, that is straight. } meaning that which is not distorted nor that which will cause confusion. that is good^ for you, in your daily life and in your Hereafter. So Allah says: and better in the end. } meaning, with regard to your ultimate end in the Hereafter. } *f ' . ' Tk i That is good (advantageous) and better in the end. } Said narrated that Qatadah said that this means "Better in reward and a better end." ' Ibn ' Abbas used to say: "O people, you are entrusted with two things for which the people who came before you were destroyed - these weights and measures. " [21 0] - *4 ' it oB oA b wjmS } 36. And follow not that of which you have no knowledge. Verily, the hearing, and the sight, and the heart of each of those ones will be questioned (by Allah). } Do not speak without Knowledge ' Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ' Abbas said: "This means) do not say (anything of which you have no knowledge). ' Al-'Awfi said: "Do not accuse anyone of that of I 111 At-Tabari 17:446. 121 At-Tabari 17:446. 131 At-Tabari 17:446.

which you have no knowledge. " I 1 ' Muhammad bin Al- Hanafiyyah said: "It means bearing false witness. ", 21 Qatadah said: "Do not say, I have seen', when you did not see anything, or I have heard', when you did not hear anything, or I know', when you do not know, for Allah will ask you about all of that." In conclusion, what they said means that Allah forbids speaking without knowledge and only on the basis of suspicion, which is mere imagination and illusions. As Allah says: (jj \jff i Avoid much suspicion; indeed some suspicions are sins. } [49:12] According to a Hadith: 4-Jit l%}\ «Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the falsest of speech.^ The following Hadith is found in Sunan Abu Dawud n What an evil habit it is for a man to say, 'They claimed ...' 151 » According to another Hadith jU U *Z1Z jJ-jJl I jj» i The worst of lies is for a man to claim to have seen something that he has not seen .^ ,e| In the Sahih it says: QgJplL Jj Jla*j of LJlp- ® o Whoever claims to have seen a dream (when he has not seen) will be told on the Day of Resurrection to make a knot between m At-Tabari 17:447. 121 At-Tabari 17:447. ,3) At-Tabari 17:446. 141 Fath Al-Bari 9 :106. 151 Abu Dawud 5:254. Fath Al-Bari 12 :446

623 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (37-38) (Part-15) tivo barley grains, and he will not be able to do ifV ieach of those ones} means these faculties, hearing, sight and the heart, ijZ} twill be questioned.} means, the person will be asked about them on the Day of Resurrection, and they will be asked about him and what he did with them. Jib\$ c- f: 437. And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height .} i38. All the bad aspects of these (the above mentioned things) are hateful to your Lord.} Condemnation of strutting Allah forbids His servants to strut and walk in a boastful manner: 4 And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. } meaning, walking in boastful manner and acting proud, like those who are arrogant oppressors. 4 Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth} means, you cannot penetrate the earth with your walking. This was the opinion of Ibn Jarir. W jofg ^j;} inor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height. } means, with your arrogance, pride and self-admiration. Indeed, 111 Fath. Al-Bari 12 :446 .

such behavior may bring about the opposite of what one pretends to be, as was reported in the Sahih: * OJ- ij | ^ ^ ji; us» f>: Ji ly 3^ uWliile a man from the people before you was walking arrogantly in his

garments, the earth swallowed him and he is still sinking down into it, until the Day of Resurrection [1] Allah also tells us about Qarun, who went to his people wearing his finery, then Allah caused the earth to swallow him and his house. 4(sSvIaji^* ott'i jf) 4All the bad aspects of these (the above mentioned things) are Sayi'uhu [hatefiil] to your Lord.) Some scholars recite this as Sayi'atan, meaning evil deeds, i.e., everything mentioned is forbidden, from the Ayah, 42 .p}\$2 4And kill not your children for fear of poverty) [17:31] up to this [38] Ayah. So everything that is mentioned here is a Sayi'ah (evil deed) for which a person is to be blamed before Allah, Who does not like or accept these deeds. As for the recitation Sayi'uhu, it is a genitive construction, meaning the bad aspects of these i.e., everything mentioned from the Ayah, 4%\ 'jjU\$ &£j) 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him) [17:23] up to this Ayah, [17:38] meaning that the worst of these mentioned are disliked by Allah. This was the view of Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. [This is the end of Volume Five. Volume Six begins with Ayah number 39 of Surat Al-Isra'.} Muslim 3 :1654.

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c5 jAl TAFSIR (ABRIDGED) (Surat Al-Isra', Verse 39 to the end of Surat AMMu'minun)

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The Most Beneficent, the Most Merciful

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - 'Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - ('Atiyah) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn 'Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and [or] some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet (ﷺ). - Qatadah reporting from

or about the Prophet All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Followthem The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet

5Ss, but they report from companions of the Prophet jg, while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathlr. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and thatstatement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, ‘Ata’ (bin Abi Rabah), ‘Ata’ Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas, Ash-ShaTjbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah,’ Ad-Dahhak, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd) Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathlr often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet 5^, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur’an’s revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki’, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn ‘Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

, / , // I' // •, ' ^ :y ; / , “A* f+r 4 £ J”? Yj i-M- cy. ^39. 77ifs is (part) ofAl-Hikmalt (wisdom) which your Lord has revealed to you . And set not up with Allah any other god lest you should be thrown into Hell, blameivorthy and rejected (from Allah's mercy). Everything previously mentioned is Revelation and Wisdom Allah says: “What We have commanded you to do is part of good manners, and what We have forbidden you are evil qualities. We have revealed this to you, O Muhammad, so that you may command the people likewise.” r-fr- 4 ijP* £ J”? Ur iAnd set not up with Allah any other god lest you slwuld be thrown into Hell, blameivorthy^ meaning, your own self will blame you, as will Allah and His creation. i&z irejected^ means far removed from everything good. Ibn ‘Abbas and Qatadah said: “(It means) cast out.” 1 11 This is an address to the Ummah via the Messenger jjg, for he is infallible. 440. Has then your Lord preferred for you sons, and taken for Himselffrom among the angels daughters? Verily, you indeed utter an awful saying Refutation of Those Who claim that the Angels are Daughters ofAllah Allah refutes the lying idolators who claim, may the curse of Allah be upon them, that the angels are the daughters of Allah. They made the angels, who are the servants of Ar- m At-Jabari 17:452.

18 Tafsir Ibn KathTr Rahman (the Most Beneficent), females, and called them daughters of Allah, then they worshipped them. They were gravely wrong on all three counts. Allah says, denouncing them: iHas then your Lord preferredfor you sons,4 meaning, has He given only you sons? iand taken for Himselffrom among the angels daughters ?)> meaning, has He chosen for Himself, as you claim, daughters? Then Allah denounces them even more severely, and says: 4^ \$3 4Verily, you indeed utter an awful saying. meaning, in your claim that Allah has children, then you say that His children are female, which you do not like for yourselves and may even kill them by burying them alive. That is indeed a division most unfair! Allah says: Z.oA cf& A& o' yji Cj !£> o' J JiK, jfcvJ oji 4)* oyUlt 4 J^=» o), 4And they say: "The Most Beneficent (Allah) has begotten a child." Indeed you have brought forth

(said) a terrible evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins. That they ascribe a son child to the Most Beneficent. But it is not suitable for (the majesty of) the Most Beneficent that he should beget a child. There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Beneficent as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And every one of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .4 (19 :88-95)

19 Surah 17. Al-Isr' (41-43) (Part-15) 442 . And surely, We have explained in this Qur'an that they may take heed, but if I increase them in naught save aversion.} Allah says: / / . > ff / . / • **** \ 4 ui/ » ^ JUJjy 4 And surely. We have explained in this Qur'an} meaning, 'We have explained Our warni- ngs so that they may remember the proof, evidence and exhorta- tions contained there- in, and be prevented from Shirk, wrong- doing and scandal.' ifeCj} ibut it increases them in naught} the wrong- doers among them isave aversion.} aversion towards the truth; they go further away from it. TA-t isas® ^ > . is ? <•: , <>> *; / > , * < ss . / . vV < • S' + ? / / > / > ^ J1 < LjI) 4- ; 4jl4 > x > v •> Zn^yjaS^j b^JM b^ic-UJ^-oD . 4jWf»i-JuJO 3 l*r J UliU-j / *£ • 'A < ' y > rf "A" 9st/i bj* > J • »-Wj *jsW j V \j»j ~kS^T" VJbtIJ * ^ ^ i * / " // < ' ^ » * / > t # ^ / ys ^4^'b/I* OJo ^ ^ 1 1Ju £«Jb^jj^k&US'b *1Vjjlij 4^ fo £ & > %\$. & * ii \$& 4 oj>; ff n/. ,ib^' jj^ 442. Say: "If there had been other gods along with Him as they assert, then they would certainly have sought out a way to the Lord of the Throne.} 443 . Glorified and Exalted is He high above what they say!} Allah says: 'Say, O Muhammad, to these idolaters who claim that Allah has a partner among His creation, and who worship others besides Him that they may bring them nearer to Him: if

20 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr the matter is as you say, and there is another god besides Him whom you worship in order to draw closer to Him and so that he will intercede for you with Him, then those whom you worship would themselves worship Him and seek means to draw closer to Him, So worship Him alone, just as those on whom you call besides Him worship Him. You have no need of a deity to be an intermediary between you and Him, for He does not like or accept that, rather He hates it and rejects it, and has forbidden that through all of His Messengers and Prophets.' Then He glorifies and sanctifies Himself far above all that, and says: &&&& ^Glorified and Exalted is He high above what they say!} meaning these idolaters who transgress and do wrong when they claim that there are other gods besides Him. 4high above} means, far above. He is Allah, the One, the Self- Sufficient Master, Whom all creatures need. He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable or coequal unto Him. "J J3j } 1 Jt ir* <>*-> PP& 4 it :4 444. The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.} Everything glorifies Allah Allah says: the seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, meaning the creatures that dwell therein, sanctify Him, exalt Him, venerate Him, glorify Him and magnify Him far above what these idolaters say, and they bear witness that He is One in His Lordship and Divinity. In everything there is a sign of Allah indicating that He is One. As Allah says:

&& !£ cJ *4 &££ ^HTiereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins, That they ascribe child to the Most Beneficent} (19:90-91). *3} *(jr J iand there is not a thing but glorifies His praise.} there is no created being that does not celebrate the praises of

Allah. iBut you understand not their glorification .} means, You do not understand them, O mankind, because it is not like your languages.' This applies to all creatures generally, animal, inanimate and botanical. This is the better known of the two opinions according to the most reliable of two opinions. It was reported in Sahih Al-Bukhari that Ibn Mas'ud said: "We used to hear the Tasbeeh of the food as it was being eaten." Imam Ahmad recorded that [Mu'adh bin Anas said that) the Messenger of Allah jg came upon some people who were sitting on their mounts and talking to one another. He said to them: "4 S' Cji lijS'j* i "Ride them safely then leave than safely. Do not use them as chairs for you to have conversations in the streets and marketplaces, because the one that is ridden may be better than the one who rides it, and may remember Allah more than he does.*W An-Nasa'i recorded in his Sunan that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said: "The Messenger of Allah sg forbade us from killing m Fath Al-Bari 6 :679 121 Ahmad 3 :439

frogs.'-HI 4& CfX iTruly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.} means, He does not hasten to punish those who disobey Him, rather He gives them time and waits, then if they persist in their stubborn Kufr, ht .eizes them with a punishment of the All-Mighty, All-Capable. It was recorded in the Two SahOis that: aail; zjj.\ iljJ> «Allah will let the wrongdoer carry on until, when He does seize him. He ivill never let him goft2] Then the Messenger of Allah sg recited: iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns ivhile they are doing wrong.} [1 1:02] Allah says: 4aIilU Ca> LA <££5 J; 4And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing.} [22:45] until the end oftwo Ayat. 4And many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing.} [22:48] Whoever gives up his disbelief and disobedience, and turns back to Allah in repentance, Allah will accept his repentance, as He says: -*» (itL J' **>- j*" 'J"')} 4And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah'sforgiveness} [4:110] Here, Allah says: 01 An-Nasat, 7:210. The author mentioned an unauthentic narration that says, 'Their croaking is Tasblh." 121 Fath Al-Bdri 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997

4£j* lIX iTruly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.4 At the end of Surah Fatir, He says: H ^ at oi U'j J i£\ 4Verily, Allah grasps the heavens and the earth lest they should move away from their places, and if they were to move away from their places, there is not one that could grasp them after Hun. Truly, He is Ever Most Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving .. .\$. until His saying; 4S'& il' JUr\$ 4And ifAllah were to punish men\$(35:41-45) (\$ V egj i5S* biX jfe-p' J)a> *j4*b J 4^1 ^45. And when you recite the Qur'an, We put between you and those who believe not in the Hereafter, an invisible veil. 446. And We have put Akinnah over their hearts, lest they should understand it, and in their ears deafness. And when you make mention ofyour Lord Alone in the Qur'an, they turn on their backs, fleeing in extreme dislike The Veil over the Hearts ofthe Idolators Allah says to His Messenger Muhammad jgg: "When you recite Qur'an to these idolators. We put an invisible veil between you and them.' Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said, "It is coverings over their hearts, "• 11 as Allah says: 4Q-& di£uj bX 'cjaj Jij xij 4^1 lyki CLj >. i; >> y . 4And they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened) from that to which you invite us; and in our ears is deafness; and between us and you is a screen hi At-Tabari 17:457.

meaning, there is something that is stopping and preventing your words from reaching us. ian invisible veil.} meaning something which covers, or that cannot be seen, so there is a barrier between them and guidance. This is the interpretation that Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him) thought was correct.

Al-Hafiz Abu Ya'la Al-Mawusili recorded that Asma' bint Abi Bakr (may Allah be pleased with her) said, "When the Ayah, iPerish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish he!} (111:1) was revealed, the one-eyed woman Umm Jamil [the wife of Abu Lahab] came with a stone pestle in her hand, screaming, "What was sent to us is somebody blameworthy, or, we reject somebody blameworthy [Abu Musa - one of the narrators - said, it is I who am not sure what was said]; we shun his religion and disobey whatever he commands!' The Messenger of Allah was sitting with Abu Bakr by his side. Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, This woman has come and I am afraid she will see you.' The Prophet jg said, jJ «Certainly she will not see me.» and he recited Qur'an through which he was protected from her: iWJZ <&' <0 \$And when you recite the Qur'an, We put between you and those who believe not in the Hereafter, an invisible veil}. She came and found Abu Bakr, but she did not see the Prophet jg. She said, 'O Abu Bakr, I have heard that your companion is lampooning me.' Abu Bakr said, 'No, by the Lord of this House [the Ka'bah], he is not lampooning you.' Then she went away, saying, The Quraysh know that I am the daughter of their master. I1 * Musnad Abu Ya'la 1 :53.

prevail, and whoever fights for it will be victorious. Only the Muslims of the Arabian Peninsula, which can be traversed by a rider in a few nights, knew it and accepted it, out of all mankind. We know best of what they listen to, when they listen to you. And when they take secret counsel, then the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a bewitched man." 447. See what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way. The Secret Counsel of Quraysh after hearing the Qur'an. Allah tells His Prophet about what the leaders of Quraysh discussed when they came and listened to him reciting Qur'an in secret, without their people knowing about it. They said that he was Mashur which according to the better-known view means someone affected by magic (Sif); it may also mean a man who has a lung, i.e., a mere human being, as if they were saying that if you follow Muhammad, you will only be following a human being. This second suggestion does not sound correct, because what they meant here was that he was under the influence of Sihr (magic) which made him see dreams in which he learned these words that he recited. Some of them said he was a poet, or a soothsayer, or crazy, or a sorcerer. Allah says: "See what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way." meaning, they will never be guided to the truth and will never find a way to reach it. Muhammad bin Ishaq said in As-Sirah: "Muhammad bin Muslim bin Shihab Az-Zuhri told me that it happened that Abu

Sufyan bin Harb, Abu Jahl bin Hisham and Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq bin 'Amr bin Wahb Ath-Thaqafi, the ally of Bani Zahrah, went out one night to listen to the m At-Jabari 17:458.

Messenger of Allah when he was praying at night in his house. Each one of them took up a position for listening, and none of them knew that the others were also there. They stayed listening to him all night until dawn came. When they left, they met up on the road, each of them blaming the others, saying to one another, 'Do not come back again, lest you give the wrong impression (i.e., that you like what you hear).' Then they went away until the second night came, when each of them came back to his place and spent the night listening. When dawn came they left, then when they met up on the road, each of them blamed the others, saying the same as they had said the previous night. Then they went away until the third night came, when each of them came back to his place and spent the night listening. When dawn came they left, then when they met up on the road, they said to one another, 'Let us not leave until we promise not to come back,' so they made a promise to that effect, and went their separate ways. In the morning, Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq took his stick and went to the house of Abu Sufyan bin Harb, where he said, Tell me, O Abu Hanzalah [i.e., Abu Sufyan], what do you think of what you have heard from Muhammad?' Abu Sufyan said, 'O Abu Thalabah [i.e., Al-Akhnas], by Allah, I have heard something I understand and I know what is meant by it, and I have heard things I do not understand and do not know what is meant by it.' Al-Akhnas said: "Me too, by the One by Whom you swore.' Then he left and went to Abu Jahl, and entered his house. He said, 'O Abu Al-Hakam [i.e., Abu Jahl], what do you think of what you have heard from Muhammad?' He said, "What did you hear?' He said, *We and Banu 'Abd Manaf competed for honor and position: they fed people so we fed people, they engaged in battle so we engaged in battle, they gave so we gave, until we were neck and neck, like race horses. Then they said, we have a Prophet among us who receives revelation from heaven. How could we compete with that? By Allah we will never believe in him.' Then Al-Akhnas got up and left him."111 y jl ij i;jr jüig^& U <14 m Ibn Hisham 1 :337

28 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr * 'ir* i\$ a4 j£=-*i 1^4 l2t 3 2 £ ^JS& Jg ? > '•?. — t?>; y— ;l> jr fj> mp* >^y ui oji^j 449. And they say: "When we are bones and fragments (destroyed), should we really be resurrected (to be) a new creation?"} 450. Say: "Be you stones or iron,"} 451 . "Or some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts." Then, they will say: "Who shall bring us back (to life)?" Say: "He Who created you first!" Then, they will shake their heads at you and say: "When will that be?" Say: "Perhaps it is near!"} 452. On the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with (words of) His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while!} Refutation of Those Who do not believe in Life after Death Allah tells us about the disbelievers who think it very unlikely that the Resurrection will happen and who say, in a tone of denial, <£& it C\} 4When we are bones and fragments.} meaning earth. This was the view of Mujahid. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that it means dust. 4\%£& U} 4should we really be resurrected (to be) a new creation?} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection after we have disintegrated and become nothing, and have been forgotten. Allah tells us about them elsewhere: i&%£ m At-Jabari 17:464.

29 Surah 17. Al-Isrâ' (49-52) (Part-15 iThey say: "Shall we indeed be returned to (our) former state of life? Even after we are crumbled bones?" They say: "It would in that case, be a return with loss!"} (79:10-12). And, ?*£ £5 }And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation .} until the

end oftwo Ayat. (36:78-79) Allah commands His Messenger sg to respond to them, so He says: &\$} iSay (O Muhammad): "Be you stones or iron,"} - which are more difficult to restore than bones and fragments, iOr some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts.} Ibn Ishaq narrated from Ibn Abi Najlh from Mujahid: "I asked Ibn 'Abbas about that, and he said: This is death." _ I 'Atiyah reported that Ibn 'Umar explained of this Ayah: "Ifyou were dead I would still resurrect you."111 This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and others.*2 ' This means that if you were to assume that you would become dead, which is the opposite of living, Allah will resurrect you when He wills, for nothing can stop Him when He wills a thing. iOr some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts.} Mujahid said: "This means the heavens, earth and mountains." According to another report, "Whatever you want to be, go ahead, Allah will still resurrect you after you die." a4 111 At-Jabari 17:463. AMabari 17:463.

iThen, t)ie\j will say: "Who shall bring us back (to life)?"} meaning, who will resurrect us if we are stones or iron or some other strong created thing? jji iSay: "He Who created you first!"} meaning, He Who created you when you were nothing, then you became human beings, walking about. He is able to create you anew, no matter what you have become. '• ,>/v iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easierfor Him.} [30:27] £•>' >> iThen, they will shake their heads at you} Ibn 'Abbas and Qatadah said, "They will move their heads in a gesture of mockery."111 This view expressed by Ibn 'Abbas and Qatadah is what the Arabs understand from the language, because the word used Fasayunghidun indicates an up-and- down movement Nughcid. A word derived from the same root, Naghd, is used to refer to the young of the ostrich, because when it walks, it walks quickly and moves its head. The same word is used to describe a tooth when it becomes loose and is detached from its place. >£* ¥ iand say: "When will that be?"} This shows that they thought it very unlikely that it would happen, as Allah says: iAnd they say: "When will this promise (i.e. Resurrection) be fulfilled, ifyou are truthful?"} (36:48) i'i+j V I*; iThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it [the Hour]} [42:18] At-Jabari 17:467.

4CJ J \$} iSay : "Perhaps it is near!"} meaning, beware of it, for it is at hand and will no doubt come to you, and what will be will be. \y\$ iOn the Day what He will call you,} meaning the Lord, may He be blessed and exalted: iWhen He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come outfrom the earth} [30:25] meaning, when He commands you to come out from the earth, for nothing can oppose Him or prevent His command from being fulfilled. Rather, it is as He says: 3.' i*j} iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) i>;\$4\$ 3 i lit ujs a\} iVerily, Our Word unto a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it : "Be!" - and it is} (16:40) r* or v>-3 iBut it will be only a single ZajrahJ When behold, theyfind themselves (on the surface of the earth) alive (after their death).} (79:13-14), meaning, it will be just one definitive command, then the people will have come out from the inside of the earth to its surface, as Allah says: fj>..} iOn the Day when He will call you, and you ivill answer with (words of) His praise} meaning, you will all rise up in response to His commandland in obedience to His will. See the explanation of Surat An-Naz'iat [79 : 13- 14)

32 Tafslr Ibn Kathir \$and you will think^ means, on the Day when you rise up from your graves, ithat you have stayed in this earthly abode, ^\} ibut a little while.} This is like the Ayah: ju i \$\$. i g 477ie Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning.}

(79:46). Allah says: 4T/ie Day when the Trumpet toill be blown : that Day, We shall gather the blue or blind-eyed loith thirst. They will speak in a very low voice to each other (saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten (days)." We knoiv very well what they will say, when the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day!"} (20:102-104). fj&ZZ. ji. U 'qyJ*LS\ Acll!' 'f?f} iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, they will swear that tlmy stayed not but an hour - thus were they ever deluded.} (30:55) jjjLJi J* -i 1*^4 .. 4 f 3^^ ££ j&1 J vi Jlij c>l& 4He will say: "What number ofyears did you stay on earth?" They will say: "We stayed a day or part ofa day. Ask of those who keep account." He will say: "You stayed not but a little, if you had only known!"} (23: 112-114). Ij-lc jiLi)' 5) 0—4 J> Jf 'ljlii lijC-J

it-^4 And say to My servants that they should say those words that are best. (Because) Shaytdn verily, sows a state of conflict and disagreement among them. Surely, Shaytdn is to man a plain enemy.} People should speak GoodWords with Politeness Allah commands His servant Muhammad (j£) to tell the believing servants of Allah that they should address one another in their conversations and discussions with the best and politest of words, for if they do not do that, Shaytdn will sow discord among them, and words will lead to actions, so that evil and conflicts and fights will arise among them. For Shaytdn is the enemy of Adam and his descendants, and has been since he refused to prostrate to Adam. His enmity is obvious and manifest. For this reason it is forbidden for a man to point at his Muslim brother with an iron instrument, for Shaytdn may cause him to strike him with it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: “The Messenger of Allah sg said: «No one ofyou should point at his brother with a iveapon, for he does not know whether Shaytdn will cause him to strike him with it and thus be thrown into a pit ofFire. »* 11 Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this Hadith with the chain of narration from ‘Abdur-Razzaq.*21 -" •Ly?j jib IifjV'j j j-j ilel vjCjj 454. Lord knows you best; ifHe wills, He will have mercy on you, or ifHe wills, He will punish you. And We have not sent you as a guardian over them.} 455. And your Lord knows best all who are in the heavens and 1,1 Aljmad 2:317. Fafh Al-Bari 13 :26 , Muslim 4 :2020

34 Tafslr Ibn Kathfr the earth. Arid indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others, and to Dazviid We gave the Zabiir.} Allah says: 4% >! gfr 4Your Lord knows you best;} O mankind, meaning, He knows best who among you deserves to be guided and who does not deserve to be guided. itfHe wills. He will have mercy on you,} by helping you to obey Him and turn to Him. 4or if He wills, He will punish you. And We have not sent you} - O Muhammad - 4±^=>j ias a guardian over them.} meaning, *We have sent you as a warner, so whoever obeys you, will enter Paradise and whoever disobeys you, will enter Hell.’ 4And your Lord knows best all who are in the heavens and the earth.} meaning, their status or level of obedience or disobedience. The Preference ofsome Prophets above Others 4And indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others.} As Allah says: ft ' » *. * — £»j>j (v* a4 J** . & (*-+-*> iThose Messengers! We preferred some of them to others; to some of them Allah spoke (directly); others He raised to degrees (ofhonor.)) [2:253] This does not contradict the report in the Two SahVis which

says that the Messenger of Allah jjg said: “Don't give superiority to any Prophet among (Allah's Prophets .s' 11

What is meant in this Hadith is giving a superiority based on

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3200–3222]

whims and fanaticism or sectarian feelings, not on the basis of evidence. If there is solid evidence, we have to follow it. There is no dispute that the Messengers are better than the rest of the Prophets, and that the mighty Messengers of Great Resolve are the best of all. They are the five mentioned in two Ayat of the Qur'an, in Surat Al-Ahzab: ifA d) t jc op (4^ ^ \$And (remember) when We took from the Prophets their covenant, andfrom you andfrom Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isd son ofMaryam.) [33:7] and in Surat Ash-Shura: !s"JO odl' oi s: (a list 3£ \$He has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Niih, and that which We have revealed to you, and tlmt which We ordained for Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it.) [42:13] There is no dispute that Muhammad is the best of them, then Ibrahim, then Musa, then Isa (peace be upon them all), according to the best-known view. We have discussed the evidence for this in detail elsewhere, and Allah is the source of help. Allah's saying, s#mi iand to Dawiid We gave the Zabur.) is an indication of his virtue and honor. Al-Bukhari recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg said: FathAl-Bari 6 : 519, Muslim 4 :1844.

" tAv 'Wie Qur'an (i.e. revea- t/s ^ ~i „>>'** was made easy f°r Da~ Xr^ SJ£ls£ji^> loud, so he would callfor tr &** -"sK >-"•>' >> "rf " > his mounts to be saddled, and^ wouldfinish recit- 0Q&jZ in8 i{0 e., the Zabur) be- , :tt\ , ./« £&*:*:{ fare thejobwasdonej' 1] ^ c/j1' !>w' a* x\$ & itCJ 4<U* 5^ jijUi <e^ <56. Say: "Call upon >' */• those - besides Him >j«-r> -^0^ whom you pretend . They '\-' >'Y. >' */• r/iose - oesiaes Him K~Sjji£-o whom you pretend . They jljlvi have neither the power ,vr ' ss.' 's>'>A t0 remove the adversity /him you nor even to shift (it from you to another person)."} <57. TTiose whom they call upon, desire a means of access to their Lord, as to which ofthem should be the nearest; and they hopefor His mercy andfear His torment. Verily, the torment of your Lord is (something) to be afraid of!} The gods ofthe Idolators can neither benefit nor harm; rather they themselves seek to draw close to Allah Allah says: 4\$} 4Say} O Muhammad to these idolators who worship things Fath Al-Bari 6:522

other than Allah, j* ctj' !£»> 4Ca// upon those - besides Him whom you pretend .> such as idols and rivals of Allah. Even ifyou turn to them, ip -p\ dgC iThey have neither the power to remove the adversityfrom you} they have no such power at all, inor even to shift (itfrom you to another person.)} to lift the distress from you and give it to someone else. The meaning is that the only one Who is able to do that is Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, Who is the One Who creates and issues commands. iSay: "Call upon those whom you pretend} Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "The people of Shirk used to say, 'we worship the angels and the Messiah and TJzayr,' while these (the angels and the Messiah and 'Uzayr) themselves call upon Allah." iThose whom they call upon, desire} Al-Bukhari recorded from Sulayman bin Mahran Al-A'mash, from Ibrahim, from Abu Ma'mar, from 'Abdullah: iThose whom they call upon, desire a means of access to their Lord,} "Some of the Jinn used to be worshipped, then they became Muslims." According to another report: "Some humans used to worship some of the Jinn, then those Jinn became Muslim, but those humans adhered to their religion (of worshipping the Jinn)."121 111 At-Tabari 17:471. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 8 :249 , 250

ithey hopefor His mercy andfear His torment. Worship cannot be complete or perfect unless it is accompanied by both fear and hope. Fear stops one from doing things that are forbidden, and hope makes one do more good deeds. X^& % iVerily, the torment of your Lord is (something) to be afraid of! meaning, one should beware of it and be afraid lest it happen. We seek refuge with Allah from that. 4 iX '-1,4.1 j' jy Jj yit of) i58. And there is not a town (population) but We shall destroy it before the Day of Resurrection, or punish it with a severe torment. That is written in the Book (ofOur decrees) The Destruction or Torment of all Disbelieving Towns before the Hour begins Here Allah tells us that He has decreed and it is written in Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz (The Preserved Tablet) which is with Him, that there is no town that He will not destroy by wiping out all its people or by punishing them, iwith a severe torment. either by killing them or sending calamities upon them as He wills. This will be because of their sins, as Allah says of the past nations: 4We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves. 11 : 101] 4:\:C±0 M jc; 4So it tasted the evil residt of its affair (disbelief), and the

39Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (59) (Part-15) consequence of its affair (disbelief) was loss.) [65:9] Qj\$ If- oj cMb iAnd many a town (population) revolted against the command of its Lord and His Messengers [65:8] and many Ayat. \jjf* iiUll ^ J V> <59. And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to make them afraid (ofdestruction).} The Reasonwhy Allah did not send Signs or Miracles Said bin Jubayr said, "The idolators said: 'O Muhammad, you claim that before you there were Prophets, among whom was one to whom the wind was subjugated, and another who could bring the dead back to life. If you want us to believe in you, ask your Lord to turn As-Safa' into gold for us.' Allah conveyed to him by inspiration (Wahy): 1 have heard what they have said. Ifyou wish, I will do what they say, but if they do not believe after that, the punishment will come down upon them, because after the sign has been sent, there is no room for speculation. Or if you wish, I will be patient with your people and give them more time.' He said: "O Lord, give them more time.a" This was also narrated by Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and others.¹²¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The people of Makkah asked the Prophet to turn As-Safa' into gold for them, and to remove the mountains (from around Makkah) so that they could cultivate the land. It was said to him (by Allah): "If you wish, I will be patient and give them more time, or ifyou wish, I will do what they are asking, but if they then disbelieve, they will be destroyed as the nations before them hi At-Tabari 17:477. These narrations are supported by the Hadlth of Ibn 'Abbas recorded byAhmad . See below 121 At-Tabari 17:477.

were destroyed.' He said, jk-i j: «A/o, fee patient and give them more time.* Then Allah revealed: 4Awd nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people ofold denied them. An-Nasa'i also reported this from the Hadith of Jarir. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: The Quraysh said to the Prophet 2\$, "Ask your Lord to turn As-Safa' into gold and we will believe in you." He said. *Will you really do that?* They said, "Yes." So he asked his Lord, and Jibril came to him and said: "Your Lord conveys His Salam to you and says, If you wish, I will turn As-Safa' into gold for them, then whoever of them disbelieves after that, will be punished with a torment the like of which has never be seen in creation; or if you wish, I will open the gates of repentance and mercy for them.' " He said, Z'Ji\ 4 jjn «Rather the gates ofrepentance and mercy. »|31 i:> 4And We sent not the signs except to make them afraid (of destruction).} Qatadah said, "Allah makes people afraid with whatever signs He wills, so that they may learn a lesson and remember and return to Him. We were told that Al-Kufah was

shaken at the time of Ibn Mas'ud, who said: 'O people, your Lord is rebuking you, so pay heed!'"¹⁴¹ Similarly, it was reported that Al-Madinah was struck by several earthquakes at the time of Umar bin Al-Khattab. Umar said: "You have changed, by Allah, and if such a Ahmad 1 :258. An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :380, At-Jabari 17 :476 Ahmad 1 :242 At-Tabari 17:478.

jr TAA t tr- Cj^QiSOS^SS[Jjjus J0l\SiZ2'{AW^tai^uii;^ U>]l^jCa tiijj <JU r. Jli tT-^ ".r? "ll I'l t * 'A' ' "1- jid' oj-i ^j£=- quake were to strike again, I will subject you to such and such."111 The Prophet gg said, in a Hadith whose authenticity is agreed upon: olJU^ 5^5 bAy**b^ Ajij *>V| /- /• ^ •*" <V » . •*/' ^ Jtij virbvi5>^aj(*t~J j* j£T ^ijij .^~^lli !ji» uliJi N U*Jij jill ott ioUAJ j4i oVJ JjLji jUjij 10SU — ojLiilJ-lj 4jI£o a^S"i JJ - .4 * > , > 4jblj U " I |W piji j ' J 1 ^ 2fi{ I-' >>"T .*C *f * *•' Ol U t 41*1 ^j*S J ' oJLP U jyyJLiu jJ <Jjij Xl><> «77te sun and the moon are two of the signs of Allah, and they are not eclipsed for the death or life of anyone. Allah uses them to make His servants afraid, so if you see them, hasten to remember Him, call on Him and seek His forgivenessJ Then he said: «O Ummah of Muhammad, by Allah, no one has a greater sense of jealousy than Allah if He sees His servant, or female servant, committing Zina (illegal sexual intercourse). O Ummah of Muham- mad, if you knew what I know, you would laugh little and weep much .»|21 ;j3j oM ili ^ SOJ ivf £4 C.j l0i SO i[JSu ifiX &jS (S^o. (0 f-V-ifr j iyili' Ibn Abi Shaybah , 2 :473 •2| Fath Al-Bari 2:615, Muslim 2:618.

42 TafsTr Ibn Kathlr <60. And (remember) when We told you: "Verily, your Lord has encompassed mankind." And We made not the vision which We showed you but a trial for mankind, and (likewise) the accursed tree in the Qur'an. We warn and make them afraid but it only increases them in naught save great disbelief, oppression and disobedience to Allah.} AllahhasencompassedMankindandmade the Visionof His Prophet a Trial forThem Allah says to His Messenger jg, encouraging him to convey the Message and informing him that He is protecting him from the people, that He is able to deal with them and that they are in His grasp and under His domination and control. U» s\j} iAnd (remember) when We told you: "Verily, your Lord has encompassed mankind.."} Mujahid, 'Urwah bin Az-Az-Zubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah others said, "This means, He protected you from them."111 iJi&i% xg\ V:j\ fis; Cf} and iAnd We made not the vision which We showed you but a trial for mankind,} Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: iJi £4 gSf tv)\ &Z Cj} iAnd We made not the vision which We showed you but a trial for mankind,} "This is the vision which the Messenger of Allah jg saw with his own eyes on the night when he was taken on the Night Journey (Al-Isra.'). 40> J '(fM>} iand (likewise) the accursed tree in the Qur'an.} refers to the Tree of Zaqqum."^ This was also recorded by m At-Tabari 17:479, 480. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :250

43Surah 17. Al-Isra' (60) (Part-15) Ahmad, 'Abdur-Razzaq and others. ' It was also reported by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas.'2' It was also interpreted as referring to the Night of the Isra' by Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Masruq, Ibrahim, Qatadah, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd and several others.'3 ' We have already quoted at length a comprehensive collection of Hadith about the Isra' at the beginning of this Surah, praise be to Allah. We have also already stated that some people gave up their Islam after they had been following the truth, because their hearts and minds could not comprehend that, and they denied what their knowledge could not grasp, but Allah caused it to increase and strengthen the faith of others, and so He says: ibut a trialK meaning a test. As for the cursed tree, this isj the Tree of Zaqqum.^ When the Messenger of Allah sg told them that he had seen Paradise and Hell, and seen the Tree of

Zaqqum, they did not believe that, and Abu Jahl, upon whom be the curses of Allah, even said, "Bring us some dates and butter," and he started eating them and saying, "Let us have some Zaqqum, we don't know any other Zaqqum but this." This was narrated by Ibn 'Abbas, Masruq, Abu Malik, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others. Everyone who interpreted the Ayah to refer to the Night of the Isra', also interpreted it to refer to the Tree of Zaqqum. i[We] make them afraid meaning, *We make the disbelievers afraid with Our warnings and punishments and torment.' ibut it only increases them in naught save great disbelief, oppression and disobedience to Allah.} Ahmad 1 :221 , 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :380. '2 * At-Tabari 17:481, 484. At-Tabari 17 :480 , 481 , 482 ' See SCLrat As-Saffat [37 :62] ' At-Tabari 17:484, 485, 486.

means, it only pushes them further into their disbelief and misguidance, and this is because Allah has forsaken them. jtt If' -wif. jtf 04U V v s«* >Jd <61. And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves unto Adam." They prostrated themselves except Iblis. He said: "Shall I prostrate myself to one whom You created from clay?"} <62. He said: "See this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite to the Day of Resurrection, I will surely, seize and mislead his offspring, all but a few!"} The Story of Adam and Iblis Allah mentions here the enmity of Iblis, may the curse of Allah be upon him and his progeny. This is an ancient hatred, dating from the time that Allah created Adam, when He commanded the angels to prostrate to Adam, and all of them prostrated except Iblis, who was too arrogant and he haughtily refused to prostrate to him. He said in a tone indicating contempt: iL± 33L 'fi jiJ: 4He said: "Shall I prostrate myself to one whom You created from clay?"} According to another Ayah, he said: ii& Jt <4 </ am better than he. You created me from fire, and You created him from clay.} [7:12) He also said, speaking to the Lord with disbelief and insolence, but the Lord bore it patiently: iff 4'&& ti} 4He said: "See this one whom You have honored above me..."}

'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "He is saying, I am going to dominate his offspring, all but a few." Mujahid said (it means), "I am going to surround them." Ibn Zayd said (it means), "I am going to lead them astray." "I 1 ' All of them are close in meaning, and the meaning of the Ayah is, "Do You see this one whom You have honored and made greater than me? If You give me time, I will lead his descendants astray, all but a few of them." Cj i jLij Cyb {i4y<ai fr% Sm SI k Yi jUi^ 463. (Allah) said: "Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all) an ample recompense. 464. "And fool them gradually, those whom you can among them with your voice, Ajlib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry, share with them wealth and children, and make promises to them." But Shaytan promises them nothing but deceit. 465. "Verily, My servants, you have no authority over them. And All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian."} When Iblis asked for respite, Allah said to him: 4Go,} I will give you respite.' According to another Ayah (Allah) said: ^ -ik d) of aftjp} 4Verily, you are of those allowed respite till the Day of the time appointed.} (38:80-81). Then Allah warned him and those who follow him among the progeny of Adam about Hell: 4'M'S'Jr 111 At-Tabari 17:489.

i(Allah) said: "Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all)} meaning, for your deeds. tan ample recompense.} Mujahid said, "Sufficient recompense."11 Qatadah said, "It will be abundant for you and will not be decreased for you."*2 4And fool them gradually those whom you can among them with your voice,\$ It was said that this refers to singing. Mujahid said, "With idle entertainment and singing,"*3 * meaning, influence them with that. ikx . pri 9 4And fool

them gradually those whom you can among them with your voiced Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Eveiy caller who calls people to disobey Allah.”*4 * This was the view of Qatadah, * and was also the opinion favored by Ibn Jarir. iAjib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry.} Send your troops and cavalry and infantiy against them. The meaning is, send whatever forces you have at your disposal against them. This is a command (related to the divine decree), as Allah says elsewhere: 4See you not that We have sent the ShayatTn against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} (19:83), [1 At-Tabari 17:490. * At-Tabari 17 :490 At-Tabari 17:490. At-Tabari 17:491. *s * At-Tabari 17:491.

meaning, to provoke them and drive them towards evil. iAjlib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry, Ibn ‘Abbas and Mujahid said, “Everyone who rides or walks to go and commit sin and disobey Allah.” * Qatadah said, “He has infantry and cavalry among the Jinn and among humans. They are the ones who obey him.”*2 * The Arabs use the verb Ajlaba when describing somebody shouting at another person. Hence it is forbidden in races to shout at one another and push one another. From this root is also derived the word Jalabah, which means raising voices. iand share with them wealth and children, Ibn ‘Abbas and Mujahid said, “This means what he commands them to do of spending money in disobedience to Allah, may He be exalted. ”*3 iand children, Ibn’ Abbas, as reported by Al-‘Awfi, Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak said, “This means the children of Zina (i.e., illegitimate children). ”*4 ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means the children whom they used to kill out of folly, without knowledge.”*5 ’ Qatadah reported that Al-Hasan Al- Basri said: “Allah caused Shaytan to take a share of wealth and children by making them Magians, Jews and Christians, and making them follow any religion other than Islam, and by making them give a part of their wealth to the Shaytan.”*6’ Qatadah said the same.’7 <M;V\$ jy’v? j 111 At-Tabari 17:491, 492. At-Tabari 17:491. * At-Tabari 17:493. *41 At-Tabari 17:494. *s| At-Tabari 17:494. *6) At-Tabari 17:495. * 1At-Tabari 17:495.

iVerily, My servants, you have no authority over them.} Here Allah tells us that He supports His believing servants, and guards and protects them against the accursed Shaytan. Allah says: 4^r#y JjQ} iAnd All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian. meaning, as a Protector, Supporter and Helper. 466. Your Lord is He Who drives the ship for you through the sea, in order that you may seek of His bounty. Truly, He if ever Most Merciful towards you .} Ships are a Sign ofthe Mercy ofAllah Allah tells us of His kindness towards His servants by subjugating for them ships on the sea. He makes it easyj for them to use ships to serve their interests, seeking His bounty through trade between one region and another. He says: I iTruly, He is ever Most Merciful towards you.} meaning, He does this for you out of His grace and mercy towards you. 467. And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him. But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away. And man is ever ungrateful.} When Harm befalls Them, the Disbelievers do inot remember anyone except Allah Allah tells us thatwhen harm befalls people, they call on Him, turning toHimand sincerelybeseechingHim. HenceAllah says: 4*151 ^1 J’iN j^-^ 4And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanishfrom you except Him.}

meaning, everything they worship besides Allah disappears from their hearts and minds. Similar happened to Tkrimah bin Abi Jahl when he fled from the Messenger of Allah gg after the conquest of Makkah, and headed for Ethiopia. He set out across the sea to go to Ethiopia, but a stormy wind arose. The people said to one another: “None can save you except Allah Alone.” Ikrimah said to himself, “By

Allah if none can benefit on the sea except Allah then no doubt none can benefit on land except Allah. 'O Allah! I promise You that if You bring me safely out of this, I will go and put my hand in the hand of Muhammad and surely, I will find him full of pity, kindness and mercy.'" They came out of it safely and were delivered from the sea. Then 'Ikrimah went to the Messenger of Allah jg, and declared his Islam, and he became a good Muslim, may Allah be pleased with him.' iBut when He brings you safe to land, you turn away.} means, you forget what you remembered of Divine Oneness (Tawhid) when you were on the sea, and you turn away from calling on Him Alone with no partner or associate. 4And man is ever ungrateful.> means, by nature he forgets and denies His blessings, except for those whom Allah protects. £ 2 } \$ a; p * ot 468. Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up, or that He will not send against you a Hasib? Then, you shall find no guardian.} Does not the Punishment of Allah come on Land too? Allah says, do you think that by emerging onto dry land you will be safe from His vengeance and punishment, that a side of the land will not swallow you up or He will not send against you a Hasib - which is a kind of rain that carries stones? This 111 Al-Hakim 3:241.

was the view of Mujahid and others. 11 ' As Allah says: Oi rf\, > (»V^ (trl® iVerily, We sent against them, except the family of Lut, them We saved in the last hour of the night. As a favor from Us.} (54:34-35) Elsewhere, Allah says: if??-? ir*. 1+?* t(h^)} iand We rained on them stones of Sijjil/ 21 in a well-arranged manner one after another o' f o* {A f ' l jy^ df, i>jV' ^)j£ iDo you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake? Or do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send against you a Hasib? Then you shall biow how (terrible) has been My warning (67 :16-17) P& * ft iThen, you shall find no guardian .} no helper to turn the punishment away from you and save you. y SS« J ft) ft 469 . Or do you feel secure that He will not send you back a second time to sea and send against you a Qasifand drown you because of your disbelief? Then you will not find any avenger therein against Us.} PerhapsHe will sendYouback to the Sea Allah says, ift ft iOr do you feel secure}, *you who turn away from Us after At-Tabari 17 :498, from Qatfidah ' See the explanation of Surah Hud. 1 1 :82

iVerily, We created man in the best stature (mould).} (95:4) He walks upright on his two feet and eats with his hand, while other living creatures walk on four feet and eat with their mouths, and He has given him hearing, sight and a heart with which to understand all of that, to benefit from it, and distinguish between things to know which are good for him and which are harmful, in both worldly and religious terms. iand We have carried them on land means, on animals such as cattle, horses and mules, and also on the sea in ships and boats, great and small. iand have provided them with At-Tayyibat,} meaning agricultural produce, fruits, meat, and milk with all kinds of delicious and desirable flavors and colors and beautiful appearance, and fine clothes of all kinds of shapes colors and sizes, which they make for themselves or are brought to them by others from other regions and areas. & £&>>} iand have preferred them above many of those whom We hope created with a marked preferment.} means, over all living beings and other kinds of creation. JThis Ayah indicates that human are also preferred over the angels. 4^ 171. (And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam (i.e. the Book of deeds). So whosoever is given his record in his right hand, such will read their records, and they will not be dealt with unjustly in the least.} 172. And whoever is blind in this [world] then he will be blind in the Hereafter, and most astray from the path.}

55 Surah 17. Al-Isra' (71-72) (Part-15 speaks about you with truth. Verily, We were recording what you used to do.) (45:28-29) This does not contradict the fact that the Prophet will be brought forward when Allah judges between his Ummah, for he will inevitably be a witness against his Ummah over their deeds. But what is meant here by Imam is the Book of deeds. Allah says: * >"Z' i (Atid remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam. So whosoever is given his record in his right hand, such will read their records,} means, because of their happiness and joy at what is recorded therein of good deeds - they will read it and want to read it. As Allah says: !£?& a) 5 iThen as for him who will be given his record in his right hand will say : "Here! read my record!} until His saying. iBut as for him who will be given his record in his left hand,} [69:19-29) %} }and they will not be dealt with unjustly in the least [Fatilan.].} We have already mentioned that the FatU is the long thread in the groove of a date-pit. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded a Hadxth from Abu Hurayrah according to which the Prophet \$g said, concerning the Ayah, y^' {s.} 4(And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam.} V • i . \ (•>* • £ \ - | * V, ^ ^ }pj) ir! irf^J LJ J>-j J£) • ft) ftrife 1 '4* ijt ^ * ""Hi ffUl

*i^~^ ^ <J j l5fj *'*** J4 : 4j lit; V '*** *j~ Iji jt il-ii ^ jiil iji: alia JL p£L» JSU ii I : J^£» j4ij| "One 0/ you tw7/ fee called and uri/1 fee given fits Book in his right hand. He will be in a good physical state, with a white face, and there will be placed on his head a crown of shining pearls. He will go to his companions and they will see him from afar, and will say, "O Allah, let him come to ns and bless ns with this." Then he will come to them and will say to them, "Rejoice, for every man among you will be like this." As for the disbeliever, his face will be black and his body will be enlarged. His companions will see him from afar and will say, "We seek refuge in Allah from this, or from the evil of this, O Allah, do not let him come to us." "Then he will come to them and they will say, O Allah, humiliate him!" He will say, "May Allah cast you away, every man among you will be like this." Then Al-Bazzar said: "This was only reported through this chain." i,jji j jij} iAnd whoever is blind in this Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said: this means in this worldly life. iblind> means, blind to the signs and proofs of Allah. ithen he will be blind in the Hereafter,} as he was blind in this world. i-Lf.±&} iand most astray from the path.} most astray as he was in this world. We seek refuge with Allah from that.12 Maw&ridAz-Zaman no . 2588 At-Tabari 17:504, 505.

57 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (73-75) (Part-15) ssssm ^ ^ ^ . V, > * * > [/>! o^Ij -U-^j !A4^j2t^|3i#e&&*6£& > »///// ^ /-z . ^ /// v< >lp ^ i>^ll t, 'V.UH<wi.^li ni >->tJ' * A /i*> »>*/--- j^~ »•' ^ \$5LioA4vjj^ >"< \ ' <' ^ / / / ^ // > ^ /•* , •* / // > •" * } ' * \ ££j)' ^ i)jV£s» iL£ iiiii Lftl . , . *» ^y_i. Wv is)j j£± iuT & >£ J VjJj 'H ~f44& • <• ,/<• •* / » '•* i i>^'" i_iw -..Ul'-iij a / **/ *' > " <> ^ >/< tjt nil juj v y v^r 473. Verily, they were about to tempt you away from that which We have revealed to you, to fabri- cate something other than it against Us, and then they would cer- tainly have taken you as an intimate friend! 474. And had We not made you stand firm, you would nearly have inclined to them a little.) 475. In that case We would have made you taste a double portion in this life and a double portion after death. And then you would have found none to help you against Us.)

How the Prophet would have been punished if He had

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3222–3269]

given in at all to the Disbelievers' Demands that He change some of the Revelation Allah tells us how He supported His Prophet jfe and protected him and kept him safe from the evil plots of the wicked transgressors. Allah is the One Who took care of him and helped him, and would not leave him to any of His creation. He is the One Who is His Helper, Supporter and Protector, the One Who is to help him achieve victory and make His religion prevail over those who resist him and

oppose him and fight him in the east and in the west. May Allah send peace and blessings upon him until the Day of Judgement. ySi* 'i 'ijj ji oj^Vi Ot b\$ C&u Sfj "OLj« §)SLi ^76. And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land. But in that case, they would not have stayed (therein) after you, except for a little while. 477. A Sunnah with which We sent Our Messengers before you and you will not find any alteration in Our Sunnah.} The Reason why these Ayat were revealed This was revealed concerning the disbelievers among the Quraysh, when they wanted to expel the Messenger of Allah ﷺ from among themselves. So Allah issued a warning to them in this Ayah, telling them that if they expelled him, they would not stay in Makkah for very long after that. And this is what happened after he migrated from them when their persecution became so intense. Only a year and a half after that, Allah brought him and them together on the battlefield of Badr, without any pre-arranged appointment, and He caused him to prevail over them and defeat them, so he killed their leaders and took their families as captives. Hence Allah said: 40:3 SS^ZX} 4A Sunnah with which We sent} meaning this is what We usually do to those who reject Our Messengers and persecute them by driving the Messenger out from among themselves - the punishment comes to them. If it were not for the fact that the Prophet jg was the Messenger of Mercy, vengeance would have come upon them such as had never been seen before in this world. So Allah says: 4& Cj} 4And Allah would not punish them while you are among them.} [8:33] XX ty. XX ijLil' jj\}

J * 'it. rn. ^J lili 'j t—3 Jd» 0 .. / > 47S. Perform the Salah from midday till the darkness of the] night, and recite the Qur'an in the early dawn. Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early daion is ever witnessed.} 479. And in some parts of the night (also) offer the Salah with , it as an additional prayer for you. It may be that your Lord will] raise you to Maqam Mahmud.} The Command to offer the Prayers at their appointed Times Allah says, commanding His Messenger jfa to offer the prescribed prayers at the appointed times: JjUji Jf} 4Perform the Salat from midday.} Hushaym narrated from Mughlrah from Ash-Sha'bi from Ibn 'Abbas: "Midday means when the sun is at its zenith." This was also reported by Nafi' from Ibn 'Umar, 12 ' and by Malik in his Tafsir from Az-Zuhri from Ibn Tjmar. 131 This was the opinion of Abu Barzah Al-Aslami and Mujahid, and of Al- Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu JaTar Al-Baqir and Qatadah J41 It is also understood to [generally] refer to the times of the five prayers. Allah said; S ifrom midday till the darkness of the night,} meaning darkness, or it was said, sunset. This was understood to mean Zuhr 'Asr, Maghrib and 'Isha'. 4^ *.%} iand recite the Qur'an in the early dawn.} meaning Salat Al-Fajr. The details of the timings of the prayers m At-Tabari 17:514. At-Tabari 17:515. At-Tabari 17:515. •4| At-Tabari 17:515, 516.

60 Tafisir Ibn Kathir were reported in the MutQ.WQ.tir Sunnah from the words and deeds of the Prophet and this is what the people of Islam have followed until the present day, passing it down from generation to generation, century after century, as we have stated in the appropriate place, praise be to Allah. The Meeting of the Angels at the Times of Fajr and 'Asr Prayers S)> iVerily the recitation of the

Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.} Ibn Mas'ud reported from Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with them both) that the Prophet said concerning this Ayah : 4^& k 4and recite the Qur'an in the early dawn. Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.} it is witnessed by the angels of the night and the angels of the dayA™ Al-Bukhari narrated from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet #5 said: *The prayer offered in congregation is twenty-five degrees better than the prayer offered individually, and the angels of the night and the angels of the day meet at Salat Al-Fajr.» Abu Hurayrah said: Recite, if you wish: ^ J3 35 ks 4and recite the Qur'an in the early dawn . Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.}™ 111 At-Tabari 17:520. [2i FathAl-Bari8:251.

61 Surah 17. Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn Mas'ud and Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet said, concerning the Ayah: i&Z Xj l\ X%} iand recite the Qur'an in the early dawn. Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.} «ji#i jji i l t is witnessed by the angels of the night and the angels of the day. I 1 This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i, and Ibn Majah. At-Tirmidhi said, "It is Hasan Sahih."*2 According to the version recorded in the Two Sahih from Abu Hurayrah, the Prophet jg said: Xas jjpl jaj 1 ° ^Aj ^A^cS'jij iOjLa'i ^Aj '.iijljSA *The angels of the night and the angels of the day corner amongst you in successive groups (in shifts). They meet at the Morning prayer (Fajr) and at the Mid-afternoon prayer ('Asr). Those who stayed among you at ascend, and their Lord asks them, although He knows best about you, "How did you leave My servants?" They say, "We came to them when they were praying and we left them when they were praying."*13 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "The two guards meet at Salat Al- Fajr, and one group ascends while the other stays where it is."*4 ' These were the comments of Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, Mujahid, Qatadah and others on the Tafsi of this Ayah*5 111 Ahmad 2:474. * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :569 , An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :381 , Ibn Majah Fath Al-Bari2 :41 , Muslim 1 :439 141 At-Jabari 17:521. 151 At-Tabari 17:521.

62 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Command to pray Tahajjud iAnd in some parts of the night (also) offer the Salah with it as an additional prayer for you.} Here Allah commands him (the Prophet jg) to offer further prayers at night after the prescribed prayers. It was reported in Sahih Muslim from Abu Hurayrah that when the Messenger of Allah was asked which prayer is best after the prescribed prayers, he said, ajdli aThe Night prayerd ' * Allah commanded His Messenger to pray the Night prayer after offering the prescribed prayers, and the term Tahajjud refers to prayer that is offered after sleeping. This was the view of 'Alqamah, Al-Aswad, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i and others. It is also well-known from the Arabic language itself. A number of Haddiths report that the Messenger of Allah jg used to pray Tahajjud after he had slept. These include reports from Ibn 'Abbas, [3] 'A'ishah*41 and other Companions, may Allah be pleased with them. This has been discussed in detail in the appropriate place, praise be to Allah. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "This is what comes after 7sha', or it **' could mean what comes after sleeping.",S| iati additional prayer (Nawafil)} means the Night prayer has been made an extra prayer specifically for the Prophet sg, because all his previous and future sins had been forgiven. But for other members of his Ummah, offering optional prayers may expiate for whatever sins they may commit. This was the view of Mujahid,'61 and it was reported in Al-Musnad from Abu Muslim 2:821. 121 At-Jabari 17:524. FathAl-Bari8:83. [41 FathAl-Bari 3:39. At-Jabari 17:524. " At-Tabari 17:525.

63 Surah 17. Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) Umamah Al-Bahili.' Lit* alj i. 1! It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud.} meaning, 'do that which you are commanded to do, and We will raise you to a station of praise and glory (Maqam Mahmud) on the Day of Resurrection, where all of creation will praise you,' as will their Creator, may He be glorified and exalted. Ibn Jarir said, "Most of the commentators said, This is the position to which Muhammad will be raised on the Day of Resurrection, to intercede for the people so that their Lord will relieve them of some of the hardships they are facing on that Day."2' It was reported that Hudhayfah said, "Mankind will be gathered in one arena, where they will all hear the call and will all be seen. They will be standing barefoot and naked as they were created, and no person shall speak except by the leave of Allah. He will call out, 'O Muhammad,' and he will respond, 'Nj ilL UJu Sj Jlu i drip JiLj iii& js b&j «orii JL.3 dritLp "At your service, all goodness is in Your Hands and evil is not to be attributed to You. The one who is guided is the one whom You guide. Your servant is before You, from You, and to You and there is no salvation or refuge from You except with You. May You be blessed and exalted, Glory be to You, Lord of the House (the Ka'bah) .» This is the position of praise and honor {Maqam Mahmud) which was mentioned by Allah. Ibn 'Abbas said, "The position of praise and honor is the position of intercession."4 ' Ibn Abi Najih reported something 111 Ahmad 5:255. 121 At-Tabari 17:526. ' At-Tabari 17:526. 141 At-Tabari 17:527.

similar from Mujahid, and this was also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri. 1 ' Qatadah said, "He is the first one for whom the earth will be opened on the Day of Resurrection, and he will be the first one to intercede."2! So the scholars consider this the position of praise and glory to which Allah referred in the Ayah: It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud. I, Ibn Kathir, say: the Messenger of Allah sg will have honors in the Day of Resurrection in which no one else will have a share, honors which will not be matched by anyone else. He is the first one for whom the earth will be opened and he will come forth riding to the gathering place. He will have a banner under which Adam and anyone else will gather, and he will have the Hawd (Lake) to which no one else will have more access than he. He will have the right of the Grand Intercession with Allah when He comes to judge between His creation. This will be after the people ask Adam, then Nuh, then Ibrahim, then Mfisa, then Isa to intercede, and each of them will say, "I am not able for that." Then they will come to Muhammad sg, and he will say, oLiJ u! gj uf» «/ can do that, I can do that . We will mention this in more detail shortly, If Allah wills. Part of that will be that he will intercede for some people who had been commanded to be taken to Hell, and they will be brought back. He is the first Prophet whose Ummah will be judged, and the first to take them across the Bridge over the Fire, and the first to intercede in Paradise, as was reported in Sahih MuslimJ3^ In the Hadith about the Trumpet, it says that none of the believers will enter Paradise except through his intercession. He will be the first to enter Paradise, and his Ummah will be the first nation to enter. He will intercede for the status to be 111 At-Jabari 17:527. 121 At-Tabari 17:528. ,3i Muslim 1:182.

raised for people whose deeds could not get them there. He is the one who will reach Al-Wasilah, which is the highest position in Paradise, which befits no one but him. When Allah gives permission for intercession on behalf of sinners, the angels, Prophets and believers will intercede, and he will intercede for people whose number is known only to Allah. No one will intercede like him and no one will match him in intercession . 1,1 This has been explained in comprehensive detail at the end of the Book of Sirah, in the chapter on the specific qualities. Praise be to Allah. Now with the help of Allah we will

mention the Hadiths that were reported concerning Al-Maqam Al-Mahmud. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Umar said: “On the Day of Resurrection, the people will be humbled to their knees, each nation following its Prophet and saying, ‘O so-and-so, intercede,’ ‘O so-and-so, intercede,’ until the power of intercession is given to Muhammad sg, and that will be the day when Allah raises him to a position of praise and gloiy .’21 Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said: JljJS ‘-’1” till* ill’ Aiili xijj }*!***! «77ie sun will come close until the sioeat reaches halfivay up one's ears. When the people are in that state, they will ask Adam for help, and he will say, "I am not the one to do that.” Then they ivill ask Musa, and he will say likewise, then they will ask Muhammad, and he ivill intercede for the people and will go and take hold of the handle of the gate of Paradise, and that will be the Dau when Allah resurrects him to a position of praise and glory . Al-Bukhari also recorded it in the Book of Zakah, where he added: I 1 ! At-Tabarani in At-Tiwal no . 36 Fath Al-Bari 8 :251 131 At-Jabari 17:529.

66 Tafsir Ibn Kathtr ^-DJi Jii ;• *1-'UUo Jill uThat will be the Day when Allah resurrects him to a position ofpraise and glory, and all the people will praise him *’1 ' Abu Dawfld At-Tayalisi recorded that ‘Abdullah said, “Then Allah will give permission for intercession, and Ar-Ruh Al- Quddus, Jibrfl, will stand up, then Ibrahim, the close Friend of Allah will stand up, then Isa or Musa will stand up - Abu Az-Za’ra’ said, ‘I do not know which of them,’ - then your Prophet will stand up and will intercede, and no one after him will intercede as much as he does. This is the position of praise and glory to which Allah referred: Ui. vitj o' ilt may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud.y’W The Hadxth ofAbu Hurayrah Imam Ahmad (may Allah have mercy on him) recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, “Some meat was brought to the Messenger of Allah 5=, and he lifted up the arm, which he used to like, and took one bite, then he said: l % 1 Villi 5 2 ' * Z *1 " " f-; i Colljil |6^J _y0l ili lib • laJl JwOW? <-> - «-X djy ^ Vj 1 V U y**1 . J! & Jy Vi i Jli l 1 L jjj 1 cjf u <~U jyfc i ^- £LLc- : oTiv! or-^ * - J[^ £fLEU i <i)J 1 aSsj^oJl ojC iui jJiL- ^ yj Oi : fST J V iJJu Ji5 U ^ . > • : i Aji U e>y Vi : ;?i' 1 ! * ' • 1 1. cJUj • Jj ‘J CJ- fdi byVj iSyA '>^1 Ixp <il ilU_ jjj M J\ J-ijjl Jji U 'jjijZi [1] FathAl-Bdri 3:396. Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi 5 1

Silrah 17. Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) 67 j] l Jj<53 V LxJj Ji U ^jt N I i <3 ^ djjj 0 £-311 Ji *->\j 4 -Iu aIL* oJjw s_wa*j /JJ Alia aLj ^ ..A»^ pJ Luip j3l «—3p 3i J[IjIwl ^yJb ^yJC jS J* 1*^0 S^S J CJ^ ^Jai j^a aJL>-j <ul \j I jjjjJa3 p-A^J jjj13 4 <*~A \jj\ : j^ii ?££ ji u j) vi i*j y*1 u j'J vi i£j Ji G ^lii <.^jSJ» '£jj — aJULa a_L*j • _ r> j t ajjLa aJls ^3iu pJ LjtP ^jli 1 v^jp jJ J {jr~*y> jjJ0> t j» ^j-aS^ i\$Jz* ij*\ cyr^ c*’?“ 4, ~ Aa *>LEjJ aj*VL--^j au! l3Ltla-j? 1 1 (Jy**j <L*i 1 j^« L ! 0jJjJLj j*^L—Jl a~1p Jj33 ?U*Jj Ji La <Sy ^ ^ c a<3 y>*j La jj>y t ^iljj j^i LJ t^01 aJj*j 3*-> /Jj 4 Alia aL\$ >— .3 *2 pJ L»J±P ^j3l 3 • -3P -3 ^j jl \y^y <jfy J! k>jt* t>r-^ 1_5-r i*’ 1 yf^ GLii cJG Ji i*ii- n PP J * ^ J •• * * ^ P * * pt * "• • liiLcJl CftKJ 4JJ I Jy~*J v^i l U ! ijyLJ ^3«*P i)yi Lj y^L^Sr ^Jl j'J vi iir. JI d ^LLii 4J1j >GI £j;j JI fjji c-ii. ji Jj ji :j-^ j^i jjii *?GJ: ji u j> vl .u JJ u i j*JJ t oJL*j ,S2*i ^ I Alla aJlj pj LJlP *i~p ' . 1 ;/ n 1 >”* . • t . 1 >”* • * <X«^va u . iijyjAJi lJLk->»_’J jjj Li i Juk^va ^Jl lJmAI ^ ^jl lJmAI i^mmSj i (, ^ ^ ' • j i +* r ' ' | ' " , » ^ • { * ^ ^ , I ^ { k J>-Ij Laj JjLjS J^a ^JuJ La <U 1 Jur jIJ i t-U-J J ^JU-J ajjl Jj-jj Oj I (»jiti V Ljjj Ji La jj N 1 1 Aji ^J>»j La ^ ^ I Jjuj ^Jl 0 oJLaUJ ly orH^j J* P 3* y). 'p’G. ^li <.Jjiji ^J-*iaJ wJL—lJ jl *L«^a U . JLLj i ^yL«J C#^ A^JL«L La 4-Lp t-0Jl J U I iu *j IJ c\$^* 'djiLi i ^aJLi ^a-11j t aLaaj *^>Gl zji ^—!’!—>- V slli^l ^ juP* U :Jlv ivjj ^Glj J 15 ct.-l^iSII i j-Gl «-l^J* ^»l_j-i j l i J- J; G5 -JJ ^jUu Jpr.J^Jl J- li jj ojJ xL>v j-A ^ijj-jzij -SU j-. US’ «/ will be the

leader of mankind on (The Day of Resurrection). Do you know why it will be so? Allah will gather the first and the last in one place, and they will hear a voice calling out, and

they will all be seen. The sun will come close until their anguish and distress becomes unbearable, and some will say to others, "Do you not see how much you are suffering? Why do you not find someone to intercede for you with your Lord?" And some of the people will say to others, "How about Adam?" So they will go to Adam and say, "O Adam, you are the father of mankind, Allah created you with His Hand and breathed into you of His spirit, and commanded the angels to prostrate to you. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Adam will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. He forbade me to approach the Tree and I disobeyed Him. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Nuh." So they will go to Nuh and say, "O Nuh, you are the first of the Messengers sent to the people of earth, and Allah called you a grateful servant. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Nuh will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. There is a prayer that I prayed against my people. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Ibrahim." So they will go to Ibrahim and say, "O Ibrahim, you are the Prophet of Allah and His close Friend among the people of earth. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Ibrahim will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again." And he mentioned some untruths he had told. "Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Musa." So they will go to Musa and say, "O Musa, you are the Messenger of Allah, Allah chose you above others by selecting you to convey His Message and by speaking to you directly. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Musa will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. I killed a soul whom I had not been

commanded to kill. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to 'Isa." So they will go to 'Isa and say, 'O 'Isa, you are the Messenger of Allah and His Word which He bestowed upon Maryam and a spirit created by Him. You spoke to the people as an infant in the cradle. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?' 'Isa will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again." And he will not mention any sin. "Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Muhammad So they will go to Muhammad and will say, "O Muhammad, you are the Messenger of Allah and the Last of the Prophets, Allah forgave all your past and future sins. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" I will stand up and come before the Throne, and will fall prostrating to my Lord, may He be glorified and exalted. Then Allah will inspire me to speak and I will speak beautiful words of praise such as no one has ever been inspired with before. It will be said, "O Muhammad, raise your head and ask, it will be granted to you. Intercede, and your intercession will be heard." So I will raise my head and say, "My Ummah, O Lord, my Ummah, O Lord, my Ummah, O Lord." It will be said, "O Muhammad, admit those who will not be brought to account from among your Ummah through the right-hand gate of Paradise. Then the rest of your Ummah will share the other gates with the rest of the people."** Then he

said, *‘‘By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, the distance between two of the gateposts of Paradise is like the distance between Makkah and Hajar, or between Makkah and Bu\$ra. ll] It was also reported in the Two Sahths.W foil .« vdiiJ if J T-' 480. And say: "My Lord! Let my entry be good, and (likewise) 111 Ahmad 2:435. 121 Al-Bukhari 4712, Muslim 894.

my exit be good. And grant me from You a helping authority,"} 481. And say: "Truth has come and falsehood has vanished. Surely, falsehood is ever bound to vanish."} The Command to emigrate Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said: The Prophet jg was in Makkah, then he was commanded to emigrate, and Allah revealed the words: 4And say : "My Lord! Let my entry be good, and (likewise) my exit be good. And grant mefrom You a helping authority."}11 ' At-Tirmidhi said, ‘‘This is Hasan Sahih.”’2 ' Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on this Ayah, ‘‘When the disbelievers of Makkah conspired to kill the Messenger of Allah afe, or expel him or imprison him, Allah wanted him to fight the people of Makkah, and commanded him to go to Al- Madlnah. What Allah said was: "2 •> -s ,;-v £>* <£•*~? J*--1- <£*••>' yj ? 4And say : "My Lord! Let my entry be good, and (likewise) mu exit be good..."}'3 ' 4i3-Lf jil* yj Jij^ 4Atid say: "My Lord! Let my entry be good..."} means, my entiy to Al-Madinah. 4and (likewise) my exit be good,} means, my exit from Makkah.141 This was also the view of ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. 151 Ahmad 1 :223. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :574 At-Tabari 17:533. Ahmad 1 :223 At-Tabari 17:534.

tC IjI— o' li iAnd grant mefrom You a helping authority.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri explained this Ayah; ‘‘His Lord promised to take away the kingdom and glory of Persia and give it to him, and the kingdom and glory of Byzantium and give it to him.”’ Qatadah said, ‘‘The Prophet of Allah jg knew that that he could not achieve this without authority or power, so he asked for authority to help him support the Book of Allah, the Laws of Allah, the obligations of Allah and to establish the religion of Allah. Authority is a mercy from Allah which He places among His servants, otherwise some of them would attack others, and the strong would consume the weak.”’21 Alongside the truth, he also needed power and authority in order to suppress those who opposed and resisted him, hence Allah said: uij Ciiji ilndeed Wi? have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs,} until His saying, u_/ij} iAnd We broughtforth iron (57:25) A Threat to the Disbelievers ofthe Quraysh iAtid say: "Truth has come andfalsehood has vanished..."} This is a threat and a warning to the disbelievers of the Quraysh, for there has come to them from Allah the truth of which there can be no doubt and which they have no power to resist. This is what Allah has sent to them of the Qur’an, faith and beneficial knowledge. Their falsehood has perished or vanished and been destroyed, it cannot remain or stand firm in the face of the truth. 111 At-Jabari 17:536. At-Jabari 17:536.

72 Tafstr Ibn Kathir J i»9tfc5 • < > :> TV £«? %> .li&ILL^ "itall * < I.If" " fr^ ,-" > f" ^Aj-C-ivg-S M - ; ,t'4\$*k./ > .< |>|^" ".i " " ".:/ /UIL» 4iib t'_ . <- ' •> ili3'&* < 0fc#ifcu*3 ^rv /> ^ i^f ^ i// LL, il£ [£j>/c j^=>jj^ oi£JLp'Ji^ffcA^4 ^^Lyl iln^iuSLiLiojJlj uj' L»_j f^l^=1)l'- «lcijj tillA_^-*i tilj| l'._ *> -jli\$jjL JI£j~ <£ A'&j y> v 4 ' &* '& iNay, We fling the truth against the false- hood, so it destroys it, and behold, it dis- appears.} Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ud said: The Prophet sfe entered Makkah (at the Con- quest), and around the House (the Ka'bah) were three hundred and sixty idols. He started to strike them with a stick in his hand, saying, j3 £> of/ > iTruth has come and falsehood has vanished. Surely falsehood is ever bound to vanish .} [17:81) Cj t*_> X} iTruth has come,

and falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect (anything).} W [34:49] 4'^L>L_i- "it 4>j>. Vj
oojj), <f~jj "lii. y> t* ^ Jy^j} i82. And We send down of the Qur'an that which is a cure and a mercy to
the believers, and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.} ID Fath Al-Bari 8 :252

The Qur'an is a Cure and a Mercy Allah tells us that His Book, which He has revealed to His Messenger
Muhammad sg, the Qur'an to which falsehood cannot come, from before it or behind it, (it is) sent
down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise, is a cure and a mercy for the believers, meaning that it
takes away whatever is in their hearts of doubt, hypocrisy, Shirk, confusion and inclination towards
falsehood. The Qur'an cures all of that. It is also a mercy through which one attains faith and wisdom
and seeks goodness. This is only for those who believe in it and accept it as truthful, it is a cure and a
mercy only for such people. As for the disbeliever who is wronging himself by his disbelief, when he
hears the Qur'an, it only makes him further from the truth and increases him in his disbelief. The
problem lies with the disbeliever himself, not with the Qur'an, as Allah says: ^ tj v Ok > 3^ iSay: "It is
for those who believe, a guide and a cure. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their
ears, and it is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away (so they neither
listen nor understand)."} (41 :44 ijLX 0\$ uS 0>[JjIj J- ^ • ?•£. m (*>J +-<r?ri 1, i ilj, 4And whenever
there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say : "Which of you has had his faith increased
by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose
hearts is a disease, it will add suspicion and doubt to their suspicion, disbelief and doubt; and they die
while they are disbelievers .} (9 :124-125) And there are many other similar Ayat. „r. . > / ' V'f'X 4And
We send down of the Qur'an that which is a cure and a mercy to the believers,}

Qatadah said, "When the believer hears it, he benefits from it and memorizes it and understands it."
and it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.} They do not benefit from it or memorize it or
understand it, for Allah has made this Qur'an a cure and a mercy for the believers. ^ >& ps .m 483. And
when V\Ie bestow Our grace on man, he turns away and becomes arrogant. And when evil touches him,
he is in great despair.} 484. Say: "Each one does according to Shakilatihi, and your Lord knows best
of him whose path is right."} Turning away from Allah at Times of Ease and despairing at Times
of Calamity Allah tells us about the weakness that is inherent in man, except for those whom He protects
at both times of ease and calamity. If Allah blesses a man with wealth, good health, ease, provision and
help, and he gets what he wants, he turns away from the obedience and worship of Allah, and becomes
arrogant. Mujahid said, "(It means) he goes away from Us."111 I say, this is like the Ayah: p di cs* i
&=>%&^ 4But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as if he had never invoked Us
for a harm that touched him!} (10:12) and; 4But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away.}
When man is stricken with evil, which means disasters, accidents and calamities. m At-Tabari 17:539.

Silrah 17. Al-Isrd' (83-84) (Part-15) 75 ihe is in great despair.}, meaning that he thinks he will never
have anything good again. As Allah says, lu& p ii Mi ^ ? *' ' ' Af .1, >?, > t' 'y >f <5 * J7'. ' ' •'
A*'C£M \ /j; tsf' <yy~? ^—• >-* -O« *U*J 4j;|^>1; t4i; >43 4And i/We give man a taste of
mercy from Us, and remove it from him, verily, He is despairing, ungrateful. But if We let him taste
good after evil has touched him, he is sure to say: "Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is exultant,
and boastful. Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds: those, theirs will be
forgiveness and a great reward.} (11:9-11) iSay: "Each one does according to Shakilatihi..."} Ibn

‘Abbas said, “According to his inclinations.” Mujahid said, “According to his inclinations and his nature.”*21 Qatadah said, “According to his intentions.”13 * Ibn Zayd said, “According to his religion.”*41 All these suggestions are close in meaning. This Ayah - and Allah knows best - is a threat and a warning to the idolaters, like the Ayah: Je ijlllt V Sii Jij} iAnd say to those who do not believe: "Act according to your ability and way" (11:121) So Allah says: iSay: “Each one does according to Shakilatih, and your Lord knows best of him whose path is right.”} 111 At-Tabari 17:541. 121 At-Tabari 17:541. 131 At-Tabari 17:541. 141 At-Tabari 17:541.

76 Tafsir ton Kathlr meaning either us or you. Everyone will be rewarded in accordance with his deeds, for nothing whatsoever is hidden from Allah. ip Oi if 485. And they ask you concerning the Riih (the spirit). Say: "The Ruh (the spirit) is one of the things, the knowledge of which is only with my Lord. And of knowledge, you (mankind) have been given only a little."} TheRuh (spirit) Al-Bukhari recorded in his Tafsir of this Ayah that ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, “While I was walking with the Prophet jg on a farm, and he was resting on a palm-leaf stalk, some Jews passed by. Some of them said to the others, ‘Ask him about the Ruh.’ Some of them said, What urges you to ask him about that?’ Others said, “Do not ask him, lest he gives you a reply which you do not like.’ But they said, ‘Ask him.’ So* they asked him about the Ruh. The Prophet jg kept quiet and did not give them an answer, and I knew that he was receiving revelation, so I stayed where I was. When the revelation was complete, the Prophet^ said: 4And they ask you concerning the Riih (the spirit). Say: "The Riih (the spirit) is one of the things, the knowledge of which is only with my Lord..."} This context would seem to imply that this Ayah was revealed in Al-Madinah, and that it was revealed when the Jews asked him this question in Al-Madinah, although the entire Surah was revealed in Makkah. This may be answered with the suggestion that this Ayah may have been revealed to him in Al-Madinah a second time, after having previously been revealed in Makkah, or that he was divinely inspired to respond to their question with a previously-revealed Ayah, namely the Ayah in question. Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Ikrimah said, “The People of the Book asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the Ruh, and Allah revealed:

iAttd they ask you concerning the Riih...} They said, “You claim that we have only a little knowledge, but we have been given the Tawrah, which is the Hikmah, <£ 4,1& he, to whom Hikmah is granted, is indeed granted abundant good.}’ [2:269] Then the Ayah •' f •*> Y-t .""*1 •Us-. J >-bl *9 J*w (3 to 4And i/ a// f/ie frees on the earth were pens and the sea (were ink wherewith to write), with seven seas behind it to add to its (supply),} [31:27] was revealed. He said, “Whatever knowledge you have been given, if Allah saves you from the Fire thereby, then it is great and good, but in comparison to the knowledge of Allah, it is very little.”111 iAnd they ask you concerning the Riih.} Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This was when the Jews said to the Prophet j£j, Tell us about the Ruh and how the Ruh will be punished that is in the body - for the Ruh is something about which only Allah knows, and there was no revelation concerning it.’ He did not answer them at all, then Jibril came to him and said: V] ' <>* ^4} £j l jJ' i j>} }Say : “The Riih (the spirit) is one of the things, the knowledge of which is only with my Lord. And of knowledge, you (mankind) have been given only a little.”} So the Prophet s££ told them about that, and they said, Who told you this?’ He said, “<>’ 4* J* Ji-^T Ji l 111 At-Tabari 17:542.

fibril brought it to me from Allahj They said, “By Allah, no one has told you that except our enemy [i.e., Jibril].’ Then Allah revealed: a&&\$6% Jiis£ ffm ££\$ iSaij: "Whoever is an enemy to Jibril (let him die

in his fitry), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it fe”m [2:97] The Ruh and the Nafs As-Suhayili mentioned the dispute among the scholars over whether the Ruh is the same as the Nafs, or something different. He stated that it is light and soft, like air, flowing through the body like water through the veins of a tree. He states that the Ruh which the angel breathes into the fetus is the Nafs, provided that it joins the body and acquires certain qualities because of it, whether good or bad. So then it is either a soul in (complete) rest and satisfaction (89:27) or inclined to evil (12:53), just as water is the life of the tree, then by mixing with it, it produces something else, so that if it mixes with grapes and the grapes are then squeezed, it becomes juice or wine. Then it is no longer called water, except in a metaphorical sense. Thus we should understand the connection between Nafs and Ruh; the Ruh is not called Nafs except when it joins the body and is affected by it. So in conclusion we may say: the Ruh is the origin and essence, and the Nafs consists of the Ruh and its connection to the body. So they are the same in one sense but not in another. This is a good explanation, and Allah knows best. 121 I say: people speak about the essence of the Ruh and its rulings, and many books have been written on this topic. One of the best of those who spoke of this was Al-Hafiz Ibn Mandah in a book which we have heard about the Ruh. ***y ^ Jd i isil oCijj GLi At-Tabari 17:543. There are many narrations about this. The narration from Ikrimah is Mursal. ,2) Ar-Rawd Al-Anf ,2 :62.

• ••& < «v i v, * •• x#- * •• - ^ /O" . / / / - x> •' i , Jijj lj5U J 3* J» „*y, *£«£=» o(<xt / / X /»/y ,/// /:'• / f - - . !>!/ . / , / . » x>!/ x - > »> ^ X -1—* jUj ,aa, ^p ia>j - • _pj V 'J) u;dl> jSI\$^^ jxg0K 486. And i/ I've willed, We could surely take away that which We have revealed to you . Then you would find no protector for you against Us in that respect.} 487. Except as a mercy from your Lord. Verily, His grace unto you is ever great.} 488. Say: "If mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could not produce the like thereof, even if they helped one another."} 489. And indeed We have fully explained to mankind, in this Qur'an, every kind of similitude, but most of mankind refuse (the truth and accept nothing) but disbelief.} If Allah willed. He could take away the Qur'an Allah mentions the blessing and great bounty that He has bestowed upon His servant and Messenger Muhammad by revealing to Him the Noble Qur'an to which falsehood cannot come, from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All- Wise, Worthy of all praise. Ibn Mas'ud said, "A red wind will come to the people, meaning at the end of time, from the direction of Syria, and there will be nothing left in a man's Mushaf (copy of the Qur'an) or in his heart, not even one Ayah." Then Ibn Mas'ud recited: 4Jdi04 u44)} 4And if We willed, We could surely take away that which We have revealed to i/ oh.^ Challenging by the Qur'an Then Allah points out the great virtue of the Qur'an, and says that even if mankind and the Jinn were all to come together and agree to produce something like that which was revealed to His Messenger they would never be able to do m At-Jabari 17:546.

it, even if they were to cooperate and support and help one another. This is something which is impossible. How could the words of created beings be like the Words of the Creator Who has no equal and peer, for there is none like unto Him? 4And indeed We have fully explained to man- kind, meaning, 'We have furnished them with evidence and defini- tive proof, and We have shown them the truth and explained it in detail, yet despite that most of mankind insist on disbelief, i.e., denying and rejecting the truth.' o£j*tA> cijj jj.45 jjjJti J_u ' - /!>» ^ , jCy»j24^ J 1^ ".f' <• -i 7* '' ^ x"v-y v. . *•/ • u — w t ji &- C £& C^i CT '.t3> lii jS •j|i«^ P2 i£L j£V? 'j£& ^1*, <->tj Jj 4 d> ^ 4^ « 2ii >*• j£v j? f^zDij *4 4U

Lord wills, He can do that. We will not believe in you until you do this.’ The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to them: •JjUi Jii »ti jl 1 4)1 JLi» «That is for Allah to decide. If He wills. He will do that to you

They said, ‘O Muhammad, did your Lord not know that we would sit with you and ask you what we have asked and make the requests that we have made? He should have told you beforehand and taught you how to reply to us, and informed you what He would do to us if we do not accept what you have brought to us. We have heard that the one who is teaching you this, is a man in Al-Yamamah called Ar-Rahman. By Allah, we will never believe in Ar-Rahman. We are warning you, O Muhammad, that we will not let you do what you want to do until you or we are destroyed.’ One of them said, *We worship the angels who are the daughters of Allah.’ Another said, *We will never believe in you until you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face.’ When they said this, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ got up and left them. ‘Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah bin Al-Mughlah bin ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar bin Makhzum, the son of his paternal aunt ‘Atikah, the daughter of ‘Abdul-Muttalib, also got up and followed him. He said to him, ‘O Muhammad, your people have offered you what they have offered you, and you did not accept it. Then they asked for things for themselves so that they would know your position with Allah, and you did not do that for them. Then they asked you to hasten on the punishments with which you are scaring them. By Allah, I will never believe in you unless you take a ladder to heaven and ascend it while I am watching, then you bring with you an open book and four angels to testify that you are as you say. By Allah, even if you did that, I think that I would not believe you.’ Then he turned away from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ went home to his family, grieving over having missed out on what he had hoped for when his people had called him, because he saw that they were resisting him even more.”¹¹¹ The Reason why the Idolaters’ Demands were refused In the case of this gathering where the Quraysh came together to speak with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, if Allah knew that they were making these requests in order to be guided, they would have been granted, but He knew that they were making these demands out of disbelief and stubbornness. It ^ At-Tabari 17 :557. This story is not authentic.

85 Surah 17. Al-Isr (90-93) (Part-15 was said to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, “If you wish, We will give them what they are asking, but if they then disbelieve, I will punish them with a punishment that I have never imposed upon anyone else in the universe; or if you wish, I will open for them the gate of repentance and mercy.” He said: uRather, You open for them the gate of repentance and mercy, n 1 * 1 This is like the Ayah ipi JiQf UCJ »; J V) o' U« -> iAnd nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamiid as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to warn, and to make them afraid (of destruction) (17:59) And Allah says: { --.r > JUZ 4 jjj % SfiMfw ;Xi)i jc JidjpL jU; IX op jl 5^,4 yii jS@^4# ip jiVi Xb ip .-,i they say: “Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets (as we). Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him? Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?” And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched." See how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray, and they cannot find a path. Blessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than that - Gardens under Ahmad 1 :242

86 Tafsir Ibn Kathir which rivers flow and will assign you palaces. Nay, they deny the Hour, and for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire.} (25:7-11) Allah’s saying, 4&J+. u &-}

until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us} refers to a spring of flowing water. They asked him to bring forth springs of fresh water in the land of Al-Hijaz, here and there. This is easy for Allah, may He be glorified and exalted; if He willed, He could do that. He could have responded to all their demands, but He knew that they would not be guided by that, as He says: 4Truly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) And Allah says: <£& ^ u\$0 %} 4And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and I've had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they would not have believed} [6 :111 His saying; 4^5 IT iii j} 4Or you cause the heaven to fall upon us in pieces, as you have pretended,} means, *you promised us that on the Day of Resurrection the heavens will be split asunder, being broken and torn up, with parts of it falling down, so do that in this world and make it fall in pieces.' This is like when they said: 4f^S\ Sj fceS* J-di 1*4 u lii££ 0)X^} 4O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth from You,

then rain down stones on us from the sky.} [8:32] Similarly, the people of Shu'ayb asked him: 4 jl lli liJi^ iSo cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!} (26:187) So Allah punished them with the punishment of the day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud), which was the torment of a Great Day. [26:189] As for the Prophet of Repentance and Mercy, who was sent as a mercy to the worlds, he asked Allah to delay their punishment, in the hope that Allah would bring forth from their offspring people who would worship Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. This is what indeed did happen, for among those who are mentioned above were some who later embraced Islam and became good and sincere Muslims, even 'Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah, who followed the Prophet jir (out of that meeting) and spoke to him as he did. He became a sincere Muslim and turned to Allah in repentance. iOr you have a house of Zukhruf.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said, "This is gold." 1 11 This was also what was said in the recitation of Ibn Mas'ud, "Or you have a house of gold."*2 ' ior you ascend up into the sky,} meaning, you climb up on a ladder while we are watching you. &C ila« j<£> Jij} iand even then we will put no faith in your ascension until you bring down for us a Book that we would read.} Mujahid said, "This means a book in which there would be one page for each person, on which would be the words: This is a book from Allah to so-and-so the son of so-and-so, which At-Tabari 17:553. A^-Tabari 17:553.

he would find by his head when he woke up in the morning."1' 4Say: "Glorified be my Lord! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?") meaning, 'Glorified, exalted and sanctified be He above the notion that anyone would come before Him concerning any matter pertaining to His authority and sovereignty. He is the One Who does what He wills. If He willed, he could have given you what you asked for, or if He willed, he could have refrained. I am only a Messenger to you, sent to convey the Messages of my Lord and advise you. I have done that, and the response to what you have asked is to be decided by Allah, may He be glorified.' ji Ji ££ ii' cLjui i*' ij u -4 494. And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said: "Has Allah sent a man as (His) Messenger?") 495. Say: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security, We should certainly have sent down for them from the heaven an angel as a Messenger.") The refusal of the Idoiators to believe because the Messenger^ was a Human - and its refutation iS-ti£C3) 4And nothing prevented men) means, most of them, lit& 4from believing) and following the Messengers, except the

fact that they found it strange that human beings would be sent as Messengers, as Allah says: 111 At-Tabari 17:554.

3 p: & JM jJ 3^ y* »/ " .. t(*£-> ^ 4/s it a wonder for mankind that We /we sen/ Our revelation to a man from among themselves (saying): "Warn mankind, and give good news to those ivho believe that they shall have with their Lord tlie rewards of their good deeds?"} [10:2} And Allah says: 4G4f. °£) ciiii, f&j }Jj £\M} 477w/ uws because there came to them their Messengers with clear proofs, but they said: "Shall mere men guide us?"} [64:6] Fira*wn and his people said: jjjU* IJ iThey said: "Shall we believe in tioo men like ourselves, and their people are obedient to us with humility!"} [23:47] Similarly, the nations said to their Messengers: jiLii Ijplj jLm dX Ui Ijjjuu 3 OjiiJi bijj i"You are no more than human beings like us! You wish to turn us away from what our fathers used to worship. Then bring us a clear authority"} [14:10] And there are many other similar Ayat. Then Allah says, pointing out His kindness and mercy towards His servants, that He sends to them Messengers of their own kind so that they will understand what he says and will be able to speak to him directly. If He sent to mankind a Messenger from among the angels, they would not be able to deal with him face to face and learn from him, as Allah says: (r^i <SSo 3} C&ijiJ' Jp «i' (A J&} ilndeed, Allah conferred a greatfavor on the believers when He sent among than a Messengerfrom among themselves} [3:164]

90 Tafslr Tbn Kathir iVerily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves [10:128] 4#^ 41^5 g#& :*,&£} i>j2 -J is U45 iSimilarly, We have sent among you a Messenger ofyour own, reciting to you Our verses (the Qur'an) and purifying you, and teaching you the Book and the Hikmah, and teaching you that ivhich you used not to knmv . Therefore remember Me. I will remember you, and be grateful to Me and never be ungrateful to Me.} (2:151-152) Allah says here: Ztjji} iSay: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security,} meaning, just as you do, yfj., \$A} }We should certainly have sent down for themfrom the heaven an angel as a Messenger}. meaning, 'one of their own kind. But as you are human, We have sent to you Messengers from yourselves, as a kindness and a mercy.' \ ' ' >*» k, v ~ ^ uo /i} a (S?. a_. 496. Say: "Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. Verily, He is Ever the All-Knower, the All-Seer of His servants."} Allah tells His Prophet how to prove that what he has brought is true, saying to him to tell them: "He (Allah) is a witness over me and over you. He knows what I have brought to you. If I were lying to you, He would take revenge on me in the severest manner," as Allah says: (UImI r K**. .. W* Jjii 'f^ 4And ifhe hadforged a false saying concerning Us, We surely would have seized him by his right hand. And then We certainly would have ait offhis life artery.} (69:44-46)

91Surah 17. Al-lsrd' (97) (Part-15 Allah said; i<jJ> if& 4 Verily, He is Ever the All-Ktiower, the All-Seer of His servants meaning, He knows best who among them deserves blessings, good treatment and guidance, and who deserves to be doomed and led astray. He says: 497. And he whom Allah guides, he is led aright; and whomever He leaves astray can never find helpers other than Him, and We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell; whenever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire> Guidance and Misguidance are in the Hands ofAllah Allah tells us how He deals with His creation and how His rulings are carried out. He tells us that there is none who can put back His judgement, for whomever He guides cannot be led astray, iand whomever He leaves astray can never find helpers other than Him^to

guide him. As Allah says: j*3 iHe whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Wall (guiding friend) to lead him (18:17) The Punishment of the People of Misguidance 4and We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces,

J assswss TST X- 4-JIJ4» 4ll>JLf>, > />>/'> . >> > «>,< ^3U;j^jji5^V5vS3fS2-jJi O^iSAjL! *u— 1 p^'jIJ /L !•/ ^ *> *> » // , * *^ j* '»»' // >4j(JlAd j]^ **^ ^r' , “ JyUx^AcjjJJl# ' ^ ' <' f-i JI'V H) p-v> 'jyj*f 4!fi'C'j£- 4So taste you (the results of your evil ac- tions). No increase shall We give you, except in torment.} (78:30) 1>S^ (Hp\ [>>J'>- <4'j^ ^ 2r w & sj^ cj && si S'£\$ \$ isVfJ 9^3' 5£ *\$ J*»j j-t^i <->' 2Jf Ji-> r<> /#•' < //1 _» t»U *j v-j 'll 1U 4:.v>:<\$' \$> oA^' 498. That is iheir recompense, because they denied Our Aydt and said: “When we are bones and fragments, shall we really be raised up as a new creation?”} 499. See they not that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, is able to create the like of them. And He has decreedfor them an appointed term, xohereof there is no doubt. But the wrongdoers refuse but disbelief.} Allah says: This punishment, being resurrected blind, dumb and deaf, is what they deserve, because they disbelieved, i&& iOur Ayat}, i.e., Our proofand evidence, and did not think that the resurrection could ever happen.’ 4u& l^e&U iand said: "When we are bones andfragments..."}

meaning, when we have disintegrated and our bodies have rotted away, l)} isltall we really be raised up as a new creation?} meaning, after we have disintegrated and disappeared and been absorbed into the earth, will we come back a second time? Allah established proof against them and told them that He is able to do that, for He created the heavens and the earth, so raising them up again is easier for Him than that, as He says: io&# be &3} iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind;} [40:57] jff-. J 'if i/i ff 4^ J iDo they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and iwas not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead?} [46:33] J4? dr. -/ 4-hi fk o' if off f'iHb iff 4' of'Pf \$ % j>: cJ liLI4 Tit ,&\ t5i 4/s not He Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of than? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, “Be!” and it is!} (36:81-82) And Allah says here: jU; j if& & 4' & aK ?f} 4See they not that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, is able to create the like ofthem.} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, He will recreate and restore their bodies, as He created them in the first place. 4Is* C*0 ^4 iAnd He has decreedfor them an appointed term, whereof there

is no doubt.} means, He has set a time for them to be re-created and brought forth from their graves, an appointed time which must surely come to pass. As Allah says: IS# iAnd We delay it onlyfor a term (already) fixed.} (1 1:104) iBut the ivrotigdoers refuse} - after the proof has been established against them, i<&& 4(and accept nothing) but disbelief.} means, they persist in their falsehood and misguidance. i -.ip &(^ ZZ ill qj \$ _)} Jif 4100. Say: "If you possessed the treasure of the mercy of my Lord, then you would surely hold backforfear ofspending, and man is ever miserly!"} Holdingback is Part ofMan's Nature Allah says to His Messenger sg: “Tell them, O Muhammad, even if you had authority over the treasures of Allah, you would refrain from spending for fear of exhausting it.” Ibn ‘Abbas and Qatadah said, “This means for fear of poverty,” lest it run out, despite the fact that it can never be exhausted or come to an end. This is because it is part of your nature. So Allah says: Af 4and man is ever miserly.} Ibn ‘Abbas and Qatadah said: “(This means) stingy and holding back.”121 Allah

says: iAte Syj. VA \$} 40r have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqira (4:53), At-Jabari 17:563. At-Jabari 17:563.

97Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (101-104) (Part-15) destruction!"} 4103. So he resolved to turn them out of the land. But We drowned him and all who were with him.} 4104. And We said to the Children of Israel after him: "Dwell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as mixed crowd."} The Nine Signs ofMusa Allah tells us that He sent Musa with nine clear signs, which provided definitive proof that his prophethood was real and that what he was conveying from the One Who had sent him to Fira*wn was true. These clear signs were: his staff, his hand, the years of famine, the sea, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs and the blood. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas.¹¹¹ Muhammad bin Ka'b said, "They were his hand and his staff, the five signs mentioned in Al-A'raf and destruction of wealth¹²¹ and the rock."¹³¹ Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ash-Shabi and Qatadah said: "They are his hand, his staff, the years of famine, the failure of the crops, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs and the blood."¹⁴¹ iYet they remained arrogant, and they were of those people ivho were criminals,} [7:133] meaning, despite all these signs and their witnessing of them, they disbelieved them and belied them wrongfully and arrogantly, although they were themselves were convinced of them, so they did not have any effect on them. By the same token, (Allah tells His Messenger here,) 'if We were to respond to what these people are asking you for, who have said that they wilt not believe in you until you cause springs to gush forth throughout the land for them, they would not respond or believe except if Allah willed.' As Fira*wn said to At-Tabari 17:564. See the Tafsirof Surah Yunus 10:88. 131 At-Tabari 17:565. At-Tabari 17:565, 566.

Musa, eventhoughhehadwitnessedthesignswhich he brought, 4"0 Musa! I think you are indeed bewitched."} It was said that this meant he thought he was a sorcerer, but Allah knows best. These nine signs which were mentioned by the Imams (scholars) quoted above are what is referred to here, and in the Ayah : V criri v4" flji* jj o*. \1C_, Cji JUat 4"And throw down your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and did not look back. (It was said:) "O Musa ! Fear not."4 until His saying, 4" prl -**j iamong the nine signs (you ivill take) to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious.} [27:10-12] These Ayat include mention of the stick and the hand, and the rest of the nine signs are mentioned in detail in Surat Al- A'raf. Musa was also given many other signs, such as striking the rock with his staff and water flowing from it, their being shaded with clouds, manna and quails, and other signs which were bestowed upon the Children of Israel after they had left the land of Egypt. But here Allah mentions the nine signs which were witnessed by his people in Egypt. These became evidence against them, because they stubbornly rejected them out of disbelief. So Musa said to Fira*wn: 4"Verily, you know that these signs have been sent doum by none but the Lord of the heavens and the earth. meaning, as proof and evidence of the truth of what I have brought to you. 4And I think you are indeed, O Fir'awn, doomed to destruction!} i.e., bound to be destroyed. This was the view of Mujahid and

Stirah 17. Al-Isra' (101-104) (Part-15) 99 Qatadah. Ibn 'Abbas said: "It means cursed."¹²¹ Ibn 'Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said: 4doomed to destruction .} means defeated. 131 As Mujahid said, "doomed" includes all of these meanings. The Destruction ofFir'awn and His People <So he resolved to turn them out of the land.} means, he wanted to expel them and drive them out. Ai' iSA Si It U-*r /u iBut We

drowned him and all who were with him. And We said to the Children of Israel after him: "Dwell in the land..." } This is good news for Muhammad sg, a foretelling of the conquest of Makkah, even though this Surah was revealed in Makkah before the Hijrah. Similarly, the people of Makkah wanted to expel the Prophet jg from the city, as Allah says in two Ayat : 4 JjyrS-i u-t \)S==3 c\j} } And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land... } [17:76-77] Hence Allah caused His Messenger sg to inherit Makkah, so he entered it by force, according to the better-known of the two opinions, and he defeated its people then out of kindness and generosity, he let them go, just as Allah caused the Children of Israel, who had been oppressed, to inherit the land, east and west, and to inherit the land of Fir'awn's people, with its farmland, crops and treasures. As Allah said, it thus We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them. } (26:59). Here Allah says: At-Jabari 17:571. 121 At-Jabari 17:570. At-Jabari 17:570.

100 Tafsir Ibn Kathir J£>j *U- bji 4 Li- ft 4 And We said to the Children of Israel after him : "Dwell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as mixed crowd." } meaning, all of you, you and your ene mies. Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said, "It means all together." 111 k> J' } 3JAj } // > / /*' > • 4105. And ivith truth We have sent it down, and with truth it has descended. And We have sent you as nothing but a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer. } 4106. And a Qur'an which We have divided (into parts), in order that you might recite it to men at intervals. And We have revealed it by stages. } / ; // -v / > < ^4 , / ^ // 4# "*" ("*" / ^ > / OyJ Vj ' Js s *y y \K" ft > . I-X»w Oldj jjJTy Juili'jsJ^SLiiii^ <Zgz0\ ipLa \$'^aJi The Revelation of the Qur'an in Stages Allah tells us that His Book, the Glorious Qur'an, has been sent with truth, i.e., it contains the truth, as Allah says: m At-Jabari 17:572, 573.

iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you ; He has sent it down with His knowledge, and the angels bear witness } [4:166] meaning, it contains the knowledge which Allah wanted to teach to you, with His rulings, commands and prohibitions. iand with truth it has descended. } means, "It has been sent down to you, O Muhammad, preserved and protected, not contaminated or mixed with anything else, with nothing added or taken away. It has come to you with the truth, brought down by one mighty in power, trustworthy and strong, one who is obeyed by the higher group (angels). ' iJiLLj Zj } 4 And We have sent you } O Muhammad iUsa& ias nothing but a bearer of glad tidings and a wamer. } a bearer of glad tidings for the believers who obey you and a wamer to the disbelievers who disobey you. iAnd (it is) a Qur'an which We have divided } , The word translated here as "We have divided" may be read in two ways. If it is read as "Faraqnahu", with no Shaddah, the meaning is: We have made it depart from Al-Lawh Al- Mahfuz to Bayt Al-'Izzah in the lowest heaven, then it was revealed in stages to the Messenger of Allah, according to events, over a period of twenty-three years.' This was narrated by 'Ikrimah from Ibn 'Abbas. 111 It was also narrated that Ibn 'Abbas read it as "Farraqnahu", with a Shaddah, meaning, We revealed it Ayah by Ayah , and have explained it and made it clear.^ Hence Allah says: & 'fax } 111 At-Tabari 17:574. At-Jabari 17:573, 574.

102 Tafstr Ibn Kathir \$in order that you might recite it to men } , meaning, convey it to the people and recite it to them, & } 4at intervals meaning slowly. 4 And We have revealed it by stages. means, little by little. '->x£ pri* ' > ! I* } 5 Oi (*V' of jj V _ } 1 34, i^Ji ji^> ^iOy ^ i>[kj; Cyjjiy SvyJ'jjj / >> 4107. Say: "Believe in it or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is

recited to them, fall down on their chins (faces) in humble prostration ."} 4108. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled."} 4109. And they fall down on their chins (faces) weeping and it increases their humility.} Those who were given knowledge before truly admit the Qur'an. Allah says to His Prophet Muhammad j&: 4\$ay} O Muhammad to these disbelievers concerning what you have brought to them of this Glorious Qur'an: 4*j~ty J* ja, ^ 4"Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it).} meaning, it is all the same whether you believe in it or not, for it is true in and of itself. It was revealed by Allah, Who mentioned it previously in the Books that He revealed to other Messengers. Hence He says: 4z& py* of 4Verily, those xwho were given knowledge before it,} meaning righteous people among the People of the Book, who

703 Surah 17. Al-Isrd' (107-109) (Part-15) adhered to their Books and appreciated them without distorting them. iwhen it is recited to them> means, when this Qur'an is recited to them, 0k if fall down on their chins (faces) in humble prostration> means, to Allah, in gratitude for the blessing He has bestowed on them by considering them fit to live until they met this Messenger to whom this Book was revealed. Hence they say: 4Z; iClory be to our Lordly, meaning, they extol and glorify their Lord for His perfect power and for not delaying the fulfillment of the promise which He made through His earlier Prophets, that He would send Muhammad. Hence they said: tfJZi iClory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled.} 400.0k \$And they fall down on their chins (faces) weeping} means, in submission to Allah, may He be glorified, and in expression of their belief and faith in His Book and His Messenger 4^0 0-0 iand it increases their humility.} means, it increases them in faith and submission. As Allah says: iWhile as for those who accept guidance, He increases their guidance and bestows on them their Taqzoa.} (47 :17). 4^0f>4 iAnd theV fall down} is a description rather than an action (i.e., this is a further description of their humility as referred to in

Ayah 107; it does not imply that they prostrate twice).

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3269–3273]

Vj 'tj ^litl •Cl.Vi' \ft-S. li 111 Iy.'J J\ ^,1 (y.lf 4 'a& i 4# ilii jlJ Jjj/i ;£ £ jju. jlil Sj^ jf £; -5j^ 4120. Srti/: "Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names. And offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud nor in a low voice, but follow a way between .> 4227. And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Wlw has not begotten a son, and Who has no partner in (His) dominion, nor is He low to have a supporter. And magnify Him with all magnificence."} To Allah belong the Most Beautiful Names Allah says: iSay} O Muhammad, to these idolators who deny that Allah possesses the attribute of mercy and refuse to call Him Ar- Rahman, 4^> \yC.j'. U ill 'sfyf' [j£al jl a! I y.jt} i"Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), by ivhatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names.} meaning, there is no difference between calling on Him as Allah or calling on Him as Ar-Rahman, because He has the Most Beautiful Names, as He says: i ^ % v 4\ iit f>} 4He is Allah, beside Whom none has the right to be worshipped but He the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen . He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} (59:22) Until His saying; ijfjij o\$3 4O' £4 1C.VI 'A}

4To Him belong the Best Names. All that is in the heavens and the earth glorify Him.} [59:24] Makhul reported that one of the idolators heard the Prophet jg saying when he was prostrating: "O Most

Gracious, O Most Merciful.” The idolator said, he claims to pray to One, but he is praying to two! Then Allah revealed this Ayah. This was also narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, and by Ibn Jarir. The Command to recite neither loudly nor softly ‘JfU %} iAnd offer your Salah neither aloud} Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “This Ayah was revealed when the Messenger of Allah ^ was preaching underground in Makkah.” \$And offer your Salah neither aloud nor in a low voice,} Ibn ‘Abbas said: “When he prayed with his Companions, he would recite Qur’an loudly, and when the idolators heard that, they insulted the Qur’an, and the One Who had revealed it and the onewho had brought it. So Allah said to His Prophet sfe: %} iAnd offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud} means, do not recite it aloud, lest the idolators hear you and insult the Qur’an, i<r, i-ij inor in a low voice,} means, nor recite it so quietly that your companions cannot hear the Qur’an and learn it from you. iO’i Cft £~}j} ibutfollow a way between.}”^ This was also reported in the Two SahihsP* Ad-Dahhak also narrated something similar from Ibn ‘Abbas, and added: [1] At-Tabari 17:580. * Ahmad 1 :23. * Fath Al-Bari 8 :257 , Muslim 1 :329

“When he migrated to Al-Madlnah, this no longer applied, and he recited as he wished.” Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “When the Messenger of Allah jgj recited Qur’an quietly while he was praying, the (idolaters) would disperse and refuse to listen to him; if one of them wanted to hear some of what he was reciting in his prayer, he would try to listen without anyone seeing him, because he was afraid of them. If he realized that anybody knew he was listening, he would go away lest they harm him, so he would stop listening. If the Prophet jg lowered his voice, those who wanted to listen to his recitation could not hear anything, so Allah revealed, 4And offer your Salah neither aloud^ meaning, do not recite aloud, lest those who want to listen disperse for fear of attracting unwelcome attention, 4C? oik inor in a low voice,} but do not make your voice so soft that the one who is trying to listen without being seen cannot hear anything at all. Perhaps he will pay attention to some of what he hears and benefit from it. ix f Jib 1C 4butfollow a way between.}”^ This was the view of ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah that this Ayah was revealed concerning recitation in prayer.13 * It was narrated from Ibn Mas’ud: “Do not make it so soft that no one can hear it except yourself.”*4 Declaration ofTawhid jtji 2 *11 4And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has *' At-Tabari 17:584. * At-Tabari 17:585. At-Tabari 17:587. At-Tabari 17:589.

not begotten a son...”} because Allah has stated that the Most Beautiful Names belong to Him, and has declared Himself to be above having any faults or defects. / > } / ji A / // /' • •!> * ^ A', 4 v J illi/i W jjj 'Jj jiO; 2 liJ' xJ-' Jsif <fAnd sfli/ : “All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has not begotten a son, and W7io has no partner in (His) dominion...”} indeed, He is Allah, (the) One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none co-equal or comparable unto Him. I;% i& inor He is low to have a supporter.} means, He is not so humble or weak that He needs to have a helper or supporter or adviser, rather He Alone, with no partner or associate, may He be exalted, is the Creator of all things and is the One Who is running and controlling them by His will, with no partner or associate. *% i&& inor He is low to have a supporter).} Mujahid said: He does not form an alliance with anyone, nor does He seek the support or help of anyone.' iAnd magnify Him with all magnificence.} means, glorify and extol Him far above whatever the transgressors and aggressors say. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Qurazi used to say about this Ayah, y 4jj, juA-i iAnd say : "All the praises and

thanks be to Allah, Who has not begotten a son . . ."} that the Jews and Christians said that Allah has taken a son; in At-Tabari 17:590.

108 Tafsir Ibn Kathir the Arabs said, "At Your service, You have no partner except the partner You have, and You possess him and whatever he owns; and the Sabians and Magians said, "If it were not for the supporters of Allah, He would be weak." Then Allah revealed this Ayah : & «% i J? ij a 4/ %& i;\$ i4\ & sai& iAnd. say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has not begotten a son, and Who has no partner in (His) dominion, nor is He low to have a supporter. And magnify Him with all magnificence End of Tafsir Surah Subhan (Surat Al-Isra'). And to Allah be the praise and blessings. hi At-Tabari 17:590.

Surah 18: Al-Kahf

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The Tafsir of Surat Al-Kahf

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3274–3289]

(Chapter - 18) Which was revealed in Makkah. What has been mentioned about the Virtues of this Surah and the first and last ten Ayat, which provide protection from the Dajjal. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Bara' said: "A man recited Al-Kahf and there was an animal in the house which began acting in a nervous manner. He looked, and saw a fog or cloud overhead. He mentioned this to the Prophet ﷺ, who said: 'Keep on reciting so and so, for this is the tranquillity which descends when one reads Qur'an or because of reading Qur'an.' (I) This was also recorded in the Two Sahih. This man who recited it was Usayd bin Al-Hudayr, as we have previously mentioned in our Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Ad-Darda' that the Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever memorizes ten Ayat from the beginning of Surat Al-Kahf will be protected from the Dajjal. This was also recorded by Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasai and At-Tirmidhi. According to the version recorded by At-Tirmidhi, 'Whoever memorizes three Ayat from the beginning of Al-Kahf. (I) * Ahmad 4 :281 (2) Fath Al-Bari 6 :719 , Muslim 1 :548 (3) * Ahmad 5 :196.

He said, it is "Hasan Sahih." In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded from Abu Saïd that the Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever recites Siirat Al-Kahf on Friday, it will illuminate him with light from one Friday to the next. Then he said: "This Hadith has a Sahih chain, but they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it." (I) Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi also recorded it in his Sunan from Al-Hakim, then he narrated with his own chain that the Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever recites Surat Al-Kahf as it was revealed, it will be a light for him on the Day of Resurrection. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. (I) Je Jjil •P 1a' o' 1— k j o j j l U r t j - J ' * o - d - / T ' s S I S ' j > ' 4 > i i ' i l . All praise is due to Allah, Wlw has sent down to His servant the Book, and has not placed therein any crookedness.} 42. (He has made it) straight to give warning of a severe punishment from Him, and to give good news to the believers, who do righteous deeds, that they shall have a fair reward.} 43. They shall abide therein forever.} 44. And to warn those who say, "Allah has begotten a child."} 45 . No knowledge have they of such a thing, nor had their fathers. Mighty is the word that comes out of their mouths. They utter nothing but a lie.} 111 Muslim 1 :555, Abu Dawud 4:497, An-Nasai in Al-Kubra 6:236 & Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :195 Al-tlakim 2:368. * Al-Bayhaqi 3 :249.

The Revelation of the Qur'an brings both Good News and a Warning. In the beginning of this Tafsir, we mentioned that Allah, praises His Holy Self at the beginning and end of matters, for He is the One to be praised in all circumstances, all praise and thanks be to Him, in the beginning and in the end. He praises Himself for revealing His Mighty Book to His Noble Messenger Muhammad ﷺ, which is the greatest

blessing that Allah has granted the people of this earth. Through the Qur'an, He brings them out of the darkness into light. He has made it a Book that is straight, neither distorted nor confusion therein. It clearly guides to a straight path, plain and manifest, giving a warning to the disbelievers and good news to the believers. This is why Allah says: /J& iand lias not placed therein any crookedness.} meaning, there is nothing twisted or confusing about it. But He has made it balanced and straightforward as He said; i(He has made it) straight}, meaning straightforward, Oi 'jjAi dV jxIJ } ito give warning ofa severe punishmentfrom Him,} meaning, to those who oppose His Prophet jg and disbelieve in His Book, He issues a warning of severe punishment hastened in this world and postponed to the world Hereafter. iZl ifrom Him} means, from Allah. For none can punish as He punishes and none is stronger or more reliable than Him. iand to give good news to the believers,} means, those who believe in this Qur'an and confirm their faith by righteous actions. ## V\} ithat they shall have a fair reward.} means, a beautiful reward from Allah.

iTIwy shall abide therein means, in what Allah rewards them with, and that is Paradise, where they will live forever. i&} iforever.} means, for always, never ending or ceasing to be. 4 | v '-dj yu fAnd to warn 1/iose tu/io say, "A/la/i lias begotten a child." } Ibn Ishaq said: "These are the pagan Arabs, who said, "We worship the angels who are the daughters of Allah." '1 ' 1 ifei -s ^ iNo knoivledge have they of such a thing,} meaning, this thing that they have fabricated and made up. AUfii inor had theirfathers.} meaning, their predecessors. iMighty is the ivord This highlights the seriousness and enormity of the lie they have made up. Allah says: - >> *- i' ' iMighty is the word that comes out of their mouths.} meaning, it has no basis apart from what they say, and they have no evidence for it apart from their own lies and fabrications. Hence Allah says: iThey utter nothing but a lie.} Reasonwhy this Surahwas revealed Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned the reason why this Surah was revealed. He said that an old man from among the people of Egypt who came to them some forty-odd years ago told him, m At-Tabari 17:595.

723Surah 18. Al-Kahf (1-5) (Part-15) from Ikrimah that Ibn 'Abbas said: "The Quraysh sent An-Nadr bin Al-Harith and TJqbah bin Abi Milt to the Jewish rabbis in Al-Madinah, and told them: 'Ask them (the rabbis) about Muhammad, and describe him to them, and tell them what he is saying. They are the people of the first Book, and they have more knowledge of the Prophets than we do.' So they set out and when they reached Al- Madinah, they asked the Jewish rabbis about the Messenger of Allah sg. They described him to them and told them some of what he had said. They said, 'You are the people of the Tawrah and we have come to you so that you can tell us about this companion of ours.' They (the rabbis) said, 'Ask him about three things which we will tell you to ask, and if he answers them then he is a Prophet who has been sent (by Allah); if he does not, then he is saying things that are not true, in which case how you will deal with him will be up to you. Ask him about some young men in ancient times, what was their story? For theirs is a strange and wondrous tale. Ask him about a man who travelled a great deal and reached the east and the west of the earth. What was his story? And ask him about the Ruh (soul or spirit) - what is it? If he tells you about these things, then he is a Prophet, so follow him, but if he does not tell you, then he is a man who is making things up, so deal with him as you see fit.' So An-Nadr and TJqbah left and came back to the Quraysh, and said: 'O people of Quraysh, we have come to you with a decisive solution which will put an end to the problem between you and Muhammad. The Jewish rabbis told us to ask him about some matters,' and they told the

Quraysh what they were. Then they came to the Messenger of Allah *sg* and said, 'O Muhammad, tell us,' and they asked him about the things they had been told to ask. The Messenger of Allah *sg* said, *jUlti* *lit IOp* «/ will tell you tomorrow about what you have asked me. but he did not say *Tf* Allah wills.' So they went away, and the Messenger of Allah *sg* stayed for fifteen days without any revelation from Allah concerning that, and Jibril, peace be upon him, did not come to him either. The people of Makkah started to doubt him, and said, 'Muhammad promised to tell

us the next day, and now fifteen days have gone by and he has not told us anything in response to the questions we asked.' The Messenger of Allah *sg* felt sad because of the delay in revelation, and was grieved by what the people of Makkah were saying about him. Then Jibril came to him from Allah with the Surah about the companions of Al- Kahf, which also contained a rebuke for feeling sad about the idolators. The Surah also told him about the things they had asked him about, the young men and the traveler. The question about the Ruh was answered in the Ayah; */ % A * * i * A * * ' / A if 4* And they ask you concerning the Ruh (the spirit); say: "The Ruh..." *M17:85].m ^ nt iagii ai Vi // . / > * / 1 > x * " / A,, • ' • * , , IUU«li yj LJ ^ as- l I''' ^ ' ^ ^ * . • > £. Lxtujj ^ * As--5 (* r » 1 Ojbjij [jllis |y»l_3 JLjjjis / > > r, / i; / ^ / ^ j- £ UL * ^ 3 J * C bin. L5l IjJfJ W. > 5 o] jJ® JLi gti « \$! & - eij £ 3 \$ > 33 d ^ ^ 46.* Perhaps, you would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps, because they believe not in this narration .} 47. Verily, we have made that which is on earth an adornment At-Tabari 17:592.

335 Surah 18. Al-Kahf(6-8) (Part-15) /or it, in order that We way test which of them are best in deeds. i8. And verily, We shall make all that is on it bare, dry soil.} Do not feel sorry because the Idolators do not believe Allah consoles His Messenger for his sorrow over the idolators because they would not believe and keep away from him. He also said: 4So destroy not yourself in sorroi u for them .} [35:8] iAnd grieve not over them .4 [16:127] vi JLi-t ^} ilt may be that you are going to kill yourself with grief, that they do not become believers.} [26:3] meaning, maybe you will destroy yourself with your grief over them. Allah says: iPerhaps, you would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps, because they believe not in this narration.} meaning the Qur'an. &} iin grief} Allah is saying, 'do not destroy yourself with regret.' Qatadah said: "killing yourself with anger and grief over them." 11 ' Mujahid said: "with anxiety." ^2 These are synonymous, so the meaning is: 'Do not feel sorry for them, just convey the Message of Allah to them. Whoever goes the right way, then he goes the right way only for the benefit of himself. And whoever goes astray, then he strays at his own loss, so do not destroy yourself in sorrow for them.' m At-Tabari 17: 597-598. ,21 At-Tabari 17:598.

jOjJx- 49 . Do you think that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} 410. When the young men fled for refuge to Al-Kahf. They said: "Our Lord! Bestow on us mercy from Yourself, and facilitate for us our affair in the right way!"} 411. Therefore, We covered up their hearing in Al-Kahf for a number of years.} 412. Then We raised them up, that We might test which of the two parties was best at calculating the time period they tarried.} The Story of the People of Al-Kahf Here Allah tells us about the story of the people of Al-Kahf in brief and general terms, then He explains it in more detail. He says: 4Do you think} -O Muhammad - oty 4that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} meaning, their case was not something amazing compared to Our power and ability, for the creation of the heavens and earth, the alternation of night and day and the subjugation of the sun, moon and heavenly bodies, and other mighty signs indicate the great power of

Allah and show that He is able to do whatever He wills. He is not incapable of doing more amazing things than the story of the people of the Cave. Similarly, Ibn Jurayj reported Mujahid saying about, 4Do you think that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} “Among Our signs are things that are more amazing than this.”¹¹ ! m At-Tabari 17:601.

129 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (9-12) (Part-15) they fled taking refuge in the cave of a mountain, where they hid from their people. When they entered the cave, they asked Allah to show mercy and kindness towards them, ///</ / / V iOur Lord! Bestcnv on us mercyfrom Yourself,} meaning, ‘give us Your mercy and conceal us from our people.’ it u iandfacilitatefor us our affair in the right way.} means, direct our matter well, i.e., grant us a good end. As was reported in the Hadith: ® Iju- oj t- jLis ^ja 0 i~ ^Wimtever You have decreed for us, make its consequences goodn .I 1 ' iTherefore, We covered up their hearing in the cave for a number ofyears.} meaning, *We caused them to sleep when they entered the cave, and they slept for many years.’ {Then We raised them up} from that slumber, and one of them went out with his Dirhams (silver coins) to buy them some food, as it will be discussed in more detail below. Allah says: iThen We raised them up, that We might test which of the two parties} meaning, the two parties who disputed about them, \jJ O&^} iwas best at calculating the time period that they tarried. } It was said that this refers to how long they stayed in the cave. Cr (*ri JpJij (i-»v o** i^r Ahmad 6: 147.

Liii jiJ x^jjJ Jt J ^_jVj Jjj Ljj 'jllii '_yLi jl .-fj_ ^li CJ^* >^gU Ij VjJ 4-4JI* x<ujj ^ 'j LLii H“4^' til <i' "ii' lij il^ ; 4i' ,J* ^Jol o*-i jJLUt X* S*P t**y ‘£*-»v j* jPj P JP 413. We narrate unto you their story with truth: Truly, they were young men who believed in their Lord (Allah), and We increased them in guidance.} il4. And We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said: “Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, never shall we call upon any god other than Him; if ive did, we should indeed have uttered an enormity in disbelief.} 415. These our people have taken for worship gods other than Him. Why do they not bring for them a clear authority? And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah.} 416. (77ie young men said to one another:) “And when you withdraw from them, and that which they worship, except Allah, then seek refuge in the cave; your Lord will open a way foryonfrom His mercy and toill make easyforyou your affair.”} Their BeliefinAllah and their Retreatfrom their People From here Allah begins to explain the story in detail. He states that they were boys or young men, and that they were more accepting of the truth and more guided than the elders who had become stubbornly set in their ways and clung to the religion of falsehood. For the same reason, most of those who responded to Allah and His Messenger sg were young people. As for the elders of Quraysh, most of them kept to their religion and only a few of them became Muslims. So Allah tells us that the people of the cave were young men. Mujahid said, “I was informed that some of them wore some kind of earrings, then Allah guided them and inspired them to fear Him, so they recognized His Oneness, and bore witness that there is no god besides Him.”

iand We increased them in guidance.} From this and other similar Ayat, several scholars, such as Al-Bukhari and others, understood that faith may increase, that it may vary in degrees, and that it may fluctuate.¹¹¹ Allah says: iatid We increased them in guidance.} as He said elsewhere: 4 . o\$} iWhile as for those who accept guidance, He increases their guidance and bestows on them their Taqwa.} [47:17] % till {JJC <<\$ uS> <As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice.} [9:124], i...that they may grow more in faith along with their (present) faith.} [48:4] There are other Ayat

indicating the same thing. It has been mentioned that they were followers of the religion of Al-Maslih Isa, 'isa bin Maryam, but Allah knows best. It seems that they lived before the time of Christianity altogether, because if they had been Christians, the Jewish rabbis would not have cared about preserving because of their differences. We have mentioned above the report from Ibn 'Abbas that the Quraysh sent a message to the Jewish rabbis in Al-Madinah to ask them for things with which they could test the Messenger of Allah sg , and they told them to ask him about these young men, and about Dhul-Qarnayn (the man who traveled much) and about the Rah. This indicates that this story was something recorded in the books of the People of the Book, and that it came before Christianity. And Allah knows best. m Fath Al-Bari 6 :426

iAnd We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said: "Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth,)> Here Allah is saying: *We gave them the patience to go against their people and their city, and to leave behind the life of luxury and ease that they had been living.' Several of the earlier and later Tafsir scholars have mentioned that they were sons of the kings and leaders of Byzantium, and that they went out one day to one of the festivals of their people. They used to gather once a year outside the city, and they would worship idols and offer sacrifices to them. They had an arrogant, tyrannical king who was called Decianus, who commanded and encouraged the people to do that. When the people went out to attend this gathering, these young men went out with their fathers and their people, and when they saw their people's actions with clear insight, they realized that the prostrations and sacrifices the people were offering to their idols should only be dedicated to Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth. Each of them started to withdraw from his people and keep aloof from them. The first one of them to move away on his own went and sat in the shade of a tree, then another came and sat with him, then another came and sat with them, then four more followed suit one by one. None of them knew the others, but they were brought together by the One Who instilled faith in their hearts. As it says in the Hadith recorded by Al-Bukhari with an incomplete chain of narrators from 'A'ishah (may Allah be pleased with her), the Messenger of Allah $\text{\$g}$ said: aSouls are like recruited soldiers. Those that recognize one another will come together, and those that do not recognize one another will turn away from each another'^ Muslim also recorded this in his Sahih from the Hadith of Suhayl from his father from Abu Hurayrah from the I 1 * Muslim 4 :2031

223Surah 18. Al-KahfC13-161 (Part-15) Messenger of Allah sgJ People say that similar qualities or characteristics are what bring people together. So each of the young men was trying to conceal what he really believed from the others, out of fear of them, not knowing that they were like him. Then one of them said, "O people, you know by Allah that only one thing is making you leave your people and isolate yourselves from them, so let each one of you say what it is in his case." Another said, "As for me, by Allah I saw what my people are doing and I realized that it was false, and that the only One Who deserves to be worshipped Alone with out partner or associate is Allah Who created everything, the heavens, the earth and everything in between." Another said, "By Allah, the same thing happened to me." The others said the same, and they all agreed and became brothers in faith. They adopted a particular location as a place of worship and began worshipping Allah there, but their people found out about them and told their king about them. The king ordered them to appear before him, and asked them about their beliefs. They told him the truth and called him to Allah, as Allah says about them: Of jJ O'jV'j oy-. ' yj tfy jJ ^ iAtid We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said : "Our

Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, never shall we call upon any god other than Him..."}

Never (Lari) implies an absolute and eternal negation, meaning, 'this will never happen, and if we were to do that it would be false.' So Allah says about them: \ uii i - if we did, we should indeed have uttered an enormih/ in disbelief.} meaning, untruth and utter falsehood. J Vjj lAjjJ ijAjld lily iThese, our people, have taken for worship gods other than Him (Allah). Why do they not bringfor them a clear authority?} Fath A l-Bari 1 :87 .

meaning, why do they not produce some clear evidence and genuine proof for their behavior? 4And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah. > They said: *but by saying that they are lying transgressors.' It was said that when they called their king to believe in Allah, he refused, and warned and threatened them. He commanded them to be stripped of their clothing bearing the adornments of their people, then he gave them some time to think about the situation, hoping that they would return to their former religion. This was a way that Allah showed kindness for them, because during that time they managed to escape from him and flee from persecution for the sake of their religion. This is

what is prescribed in the ShaiTah during times of trial and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3289–3291]

persecution - a person who fears for his religion should flee from his persecutors, as was reported in the Hadlth: jLaH ,*ilykj JC>Jt Lie- (JU Ji Zi4i aSoon there will come a time when the best wealth any of you can have will be sheep, which he can follow to the tops of the mountains and places where rain falls, (fleeing) for the sake of his religion from persecution. In such cases, it is allowed to seclude oneself from people, but this is not prescribed in any other case, because by such seclusion one loses the benefits of congregational and Friday prayers. These young men were determined to flee from their people, and Allah decreed that for them, as He says about them, 4And when you withdraw from them, and that which they worship, except Allah , \$> meaning, when you depart from them and follow a different religion, opposing their worship of others besides Allah, then hi Path Al-Bdri 7:11.

125Surah 18. Al-Kahf (13-16) (Part-15) separate from them in a physical sense too. 4then seek refuge in the cave; your Lord will open a way for youfrom His mercy meaning, He will bestow His mercy upon you, by which He will conceal you from your people. 4and xvill make easy for you your affair.\$ means, He will give you what you need. So they left and fled to the cave where they sought refuge. Then their people noticed they were missing, and the king looked for them, and it was said when he could not find them that Allah concealed them from him so that he could not find any trace of them or any information about them, as Allah concealed His Prophet Muhammad jg and his Companion [Abu Bakr] As-Sidd!q, when they sought refuge in the cave of Thawr. The Quraysh idolaters came in pursuit, but they did not find him even though they passed right by him. When the Messenger of Allah \$g noticed that As-Sidd!q was anxious and said, "O Messenger of Allah, if one of them looks down at the place of his feet, he will see us," he told him: iil j£\j U Jz d u» «0 Abu Bakr, what do you think of two who have Allah as their third?» And Allah said: i!0 Cjf i£ji H& yfi ^ sti y .***# i! & !#£. jd 4If you help him not, for Allah did indeed help him when the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two;

when they were in the cave, he said to his companion: “Do not grieve, surely, Allah is with us.” Then Allah sent down His tranquillity upon him, and strengthened him with forces which

you saw not, and made the word of those who disbelieved the lower, while the Word of Allah became the higher ; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise. [9:40]

The story of this cave (Thawr) is far greater and more

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3291–3298]

wondrous than that of the people of the Cave. o'j preA1 --i -& if" jj'y J5 ji&. cA *¥ ij hi }^S 4 Jiliri .
 •{ A- >r - 427. And you might have seen the sun, when it rose, declining to the right from their cave, and when it set, turning away from them to the left, while they lay in the midst of the cave. That is from the Aydt of Allah. He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided ; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no guardian to lead him.} The Location of the Cave This indicates that the entrance to the cave faced north, because Allah tells us that when the sun was rising, sunlight entered the cave 4the right}, meaning that the shade decreased towards the right, as Ibn ‘Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said: ideclining} means leaning. 1 11 Every time the sun rises on the horizon, its rays decline until there is nothing left in such a place when it reaches its zenith. So Allah said, 4JV4J' O'i 'i}j^ 4and when it set, turning away from them to the left,} meaning, it entered their cave from the left of its entrance, which means from the west. This proves what we say, and it is clear to anyone who thinks about the matter and has some knowledge of astronomy and the paths of the sun, moon and stars. If the m At-Tabari 17:620.

227Surah 18. Al-Kahf(17) (Part-15) entrance of the cave faced east, nothing would have entered it when the sun set, and if it faced the direction of the Qiblah (in this case, south), nothing would have entered it at the time of sunrise or sunset, and the shadows would have leaned neither to the right nor the left. If it had faced west, nothing would have entered it at the time of sunrise, until after the sun had passed its zenith, and would have stayed until sunset. This supports what we have said, and to Allah is the praise. Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said that “turning away from them” means that it would shine on them and then leave them. 11 ' Allah has told us this, and He wants us to understand it and ponder its meaning, but He did not tell us the location of this cave, i.e., in which country on earth it is, because there is no benefit for us in knowing that, and no legislative objective behind it. If there was any spiritual or religious interest that could be served by our knowing that, Allah and His Messenger would have taught us about it, as the Prophet *g said: Ai;, Vi &ji Ji ‘f&’X Up Is) u» “/ have not left anything that will bring you closer to Paradise and keep xjou further away from Hell but I have certainly taught you about if.»|21 So Allah has told us about the features of the cave, but He did not tell us where it is, and He said, 0* jjy lit piiit Sjj} iAnd you might have seen the sun, when it rose, declining from their cave.} Malik narrated from Zayd bin Aslam, “Leaning.” ithe right, and when it set, turning away from them to the left, while they lay in the midst of the cave.} meaning, the sun entered the cave without touching them, because if it had touched them, it would have burnt them At-Tabari 17:621 ,622. ‘Abdur-Razzaq 11:125.

yj^C'p S^>t3 JLft-LS \O^3j*pu»pu <JW~M ^^ •*u'X >i •' ^ 4Ji liJVj 4J^4 Uili^j'^Ll^j^ J-^i
 >"g ;.l^JL^^o^jjOwj'oU^^iaiJj3Jp-&J ^-i^bjJxyil J4254&&-.J\$ ^ V / /»rf x ^ z y» ^ //{ 0>3 ^
 UjJL^ /fSoj)^> oj^Stjo^ iis^ ^ 1-ZjiliUIjljjob(H-^; (jp ^=*jj~jjj\ ^5^ bodies and clothes. This was
 the view of Ibn 'Abbas. 111 foil •U oj LtU'i>7 iThat is from the Ayat of Allah), how He guided them to
 this cave where He kept them alive, and the sun and wind entered the cave preserving their bodies.
 Allah says, 4«i' Oi>* 02 Zlli^ iThat is from the Ayat of Allah.) Then He says: if+S\ ii' -4-' l>*) iHe
 whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided;) meaning that He is the One Who guided these young men
 to true guidance among their people, for the one whom Allah guides is truly guided, and the one whom
 Allah leaves astray will find no one to guide him. ^ jLo >4& 3,i3' 3& j£\ o'S -fgfj :>j& ^j) Wj\Slj |iy-2
 oiUJj >4-2 0^15 (vj^6 oil*' jJ il8. And you ivould have thought them awake, whereas they were asleep.
 And \Ne turned than on their right and on their left sides, and their dog stretching forth his two forelegs
 at the Wasid. Had you happened upon them, you would certainly have turned back from than in flight,
 and would certainly have been filled with awe of them.) m At-Tabari 17:620.

Their Sleep in the Cave Some of the scholars mentioned that when Allah caused them to sleep, their
 eyelids did not close, lest disintegration took hold of them. If their eyes remained open to the air, this
 would be better for the sake of preservation. Allah says: '6i\z3\$ iAnd you ivould have thought them
 aivake, whereas they were asleep. > It was mentioned that when the wolf sleeps, it closes one eye and
 keeps one eye open, then it switches eyes while asleep. ^JV* o'jj o'S j ^ iAnd VVe turned them on their
 right and on their left sides,} Ibn 'Abbas said: "If they did not turn over, the earth would have
 consumed them."111 iand their dog stretching forth his two forelegs at the Wastd} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid,
 Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said: "The Wasld means the threshold."121 Ibn 'Abbas said: "By the
 door."131 It was said: "On the ground." The correct view is that it means on the threshold, i.e., at the
 door. iVerily, it shall be closed upon them} [104:81 Their dog lay down at the door, as is the habit of
 dogs. Ibn Jurayj said, "He was guarding the door for them."141 It was his nature and habit to lie down
 at their door as if guarding them. He was sitting outside the door, because the angels do not enter a
 house in which there is a dog, as was reported in As- Sahih, nor do they enter a house in which there is
 an image, a person in a state of ritual impurity or a disbeliever, as was At-Tabari 17:620. At-Tabari
 17:624,625. At-Tabari 17:625. 141 At-Tabari 17:625.

narrated in the Hasan Hadith)^ The blessing they enjoyed extended to their dog, so the sleep that
 overtook them overtook him too. This is the benefit of accompanying good people, and so this dog
 attained fame and stature. It was said that he was the hunting dog of one of the people which is the
 more appropriate view, or that he was the dog of the king's cook, who shared their religious views, and
 brought his dog with him. And Allah knows best. Allah says: >4-4 (n?6 cJjii' ffr 4Had you happened
 upon them, you ivould certainly have turned back from them in flight, and ivould certainly have been
 filled with awe of them> meaning that Allah made them appear dreadful, so that no one could look at
 them without being filled with terror, because of the frightening appearance they had been given. This
 was so that no one would come near them or touch them until the appointed time when their sleep
 would come to an end as Allah willed, because of the wisdom, clear proof and great mercy involved in
 that. j'1 L*jji LSLj iyii jsLi J'j-® (44: j£2 iixjf ji fey fU) c %\ iju y; o) (f*! .4 jt— 1*j **—4 3^/ ULd.^
 1,1: 4 v 'll ob j j'1 >C*4i bjfh 419. Likeivise, We ivoke them that they might question one another. A
 speaker among them said: "How long have you stayed (here)?" They said: "We have stayed a day or part

of a day." They said: "Your Lord knows best how long you have stayed (here). So send one of you with this silver coin of yours to the town, and let him find out which is the Azka food, and bring some of that to you. And let him be careful and let no man know of you." > 420. "For, if they come to know of you, they will stone you or turn you back to their religion ; and in that case you will never be successful ." 4 m Abu Dawud 2 :192-193 with different wording.

131 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (19-20) (Part-15 Their awakening and sending One of Themselves to buy Food Allah says: 'just as We caused them to sleep, We resurrected them with their bodies, hair and skin intact, and nothing lacking in their form and appearance.' This was after three hundred and nine years. This is why they asked each other, 'How long have you stayed (here)?' meaning, 'how long have you slept?' 4-^ji iThey said: "VJe have stayed a day or part of a day."} because they entered the cave at the beginning of the day, and they woke up at the end of the day, which is why they then said, 4^4 -{Ji J**! 4". ..or a part of a day." They said: "Your Lord knows best how long you have stayed..."} meaning, 'Allah knows best about your situation.' It seems that they were not sure about how long they had slept, and Allah knows best. Then they turned their attention to more pressing matters, like their need for food and drink, so they said: iSo send one of you with this silver coin of yours ^ They had brought with them some Dirhams (silver coins) from their homes, to buy whatever they might need, and they had given some in charity and kept some, so they said: iSo said one of you with this silver coin of yours to the town,} meaning to their city, which they had left. The definite article indicates that they were referring to a known city. ita,&\$ iand let him find out which is the Azka food.} Azka means "purest", as Allah says elsewhere. ^ jfi* £ £ iCJ-jj jit jii

4And had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you, not one of you would ever have been pure [Zaka from sins^ [24:21] and indeed whosoever purifies himself fTazakka] shall achieve success.} [87:14] From the same root also comes the word Zakah, which makes one's wealth good and purifies it. 4And let him be careful meaning when he goes out buying food and coming back. They were telling him to conceal himself as much as he could, 4444. ij^+L jt \x4 4and let no man know of you. For, if they come to know of you, they will stone you} means, 'if they find out where you are,' it they will stone you or turn you back to their religion ;} They were referring to the followers of Decianus, who they were afraid might find out where they were, and punish them with all kinds of torture until they made them go back to their former religion, or until they died, for if they agreed to go back to their (old) religion, they would never attain success in this world or the Hereafter. So they said: <\5d 'H 542 4and in that case you will never be successful.} o&Z ii ^ ^ & ipU iSI4^j} jl+> \4) yul (4^ 421. And thus We made their case known, that they might know that the promise of Allah is true, and that there can be no doubt about the Hour. (Remember) when they (the people)

233 Surah 18. Al-Kahf(21) (Part-15) disputed among themselves about their case, they said: "Construct a building over them; their Lord knows best about them," (then) those who won their point said: "We verily, shall build a place of worship over them."}

How the People of the City came to know about Them;

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3298–3303]

building a Memorial over the Cave il'i£=*)} . 4And thus We made their case known,} means, “We caused the people to find them.’ /•• <r«/ < '/. s • <J/ , ^f f •«>*” vjj V itLlii ol> *sA juj 4that they might know that the promise of Allah is true, and that there can be no doubt about the Hour.} Several scholars of the Salaf mentioned that the people of that time were skeptical about the Resurrection. ‘Ikrimah said: “There was a group of them who said that the souls would be resurrected but not the bodies, so Allah resurrected the people of the Cave as a sign and proof of resurrection.” ’ They mentioned that when they wanted to send one of their members out to the city to buy them something to eat, he disguised himself and set out walking by a different route, until he reached the city, which they said was called Daqsus. He thought that it was not long since he left it, but in fact century after century, generation after generation, nation after nation had passed, and the country and its people had changed. He saw no local landmarks that he recognized, and he did not recognize any of the people, elite or commoners. He began to feel confused and said to himself, “Maybe I am crazy or deluded, maybe I sun dreaming.” Then he said, “By Allah, I am nothing of the sort, what I know I saw last night was different from this.” Then he said, “I had better get out of here.” Then he went to one of the men selling food, gave him the money he had and asked him to sell him some food. When the man saw the money he did not recognize it or its imprint, so he passed it to his neighbor and they all began to pass it Tdrikh At-fabari 2:9.

m aaeaffitt V,4^ose who won their ' point said: “We verily, ghall tuild a place of worship over them.”} ^ W- c. >M-^rv> -rr-t Those who said this were the people of >^5.y:r,@ power and influence, but were they good UypfJS people or not? There is some debate on r/ „' c ^ 's' this point, because the Prophet sg said: i>4p' «*>' Cr*' lit^>, >>41 J-^5 fiy^^v3V^ r^Uj <lAllsh has cursed lhe«Allsh has cursed the Op who took the graves of «M> ProP’’cte “>? ri*w >--- s&fty V> e0HS Peore flS P’aces °f <Jc^=>otdid c£'jl\$ p '-*_»Az4^2-ij zuors/n)^' Warning y? what they •f-^ " - - " IIWe have reported about the Commander of the faithful TJmar bin Al-Khattab that when he found the grave ofDanyal (Daniel) in Iraq during his period ofrule, he gave orders that news of this grave should be withheld from the people, and that the inscription containing mention of battles etc., that they found there should be buried. 12 ' ^ ^>£ L± '4y^> & Jp * 3ft y f&k £nh ft4 i ^ 4^jtU >fj V^5 ij (r& 422 . They say they were three, the dog being the fourth among 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :634. ' Al-Bidayah Wan-Nihayah 7 :88.

them; and they say they were five, the dog being the sixth, guessing at the unseen; and they say they were seven, and the dog being the eighth. Say: "My Lord knows best their number; none knows them but a few." So debate not except with the clear proof. And consult not any of them (about the people of the Cave).} TheirNumber Allah tells us that people disputed over the number of the people of the Cave. The Ayah mentions three views, proving that there was no fourth suggestion. Allah indicates that the first two opinions are invalid, by saying, iguessittg at the unseen}, meaning that they spoke without knowledge, like a person who aims at an unknown target - he is hardly likely to hit it, and ifhe does, it was not on purpose. Then Allah mentions the third opinion, and does not comment on it, or He affirms it by saying, iand the dog being the eighth.} indicating that this is correct and this is what happened. 4Say: "My Lord knows best their number..."} indicating that the best thing to do in matters like this is to refer knowledge to Allah, because there is no need to indulge in discussing such matters without knowledge. If we are given knowledge of a matter, then we may talk about it, otherwise we should refrain. i±4% inone knows them but afew.} of mankind. Qatadah said that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “I am one

of the few mentioned in this Ayah; they were seven.” Ibn Jurayj also narrated that ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani narrated from him, “I am one of those referred to in this Ayah,” At-Tabari 17:642.

137 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (23-24) (Part-15 and he would say: “Their number was seven.” Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said: in one blow they were a few.} “I am one of the few, and they were seven.” The chains of these reports narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, which say that they were seven, are Sahih, and this is in accordance with what we have stated above. 4 So debate not except with the clear proof.} meaning, gently and politely, for there is not a great deal to be gained from knowing about that. } And consult not any of them (about the people of the Cave).} meaning, They do not have any knowledge about it except what they make up, guessing at the unseen; they have no evidence from an infallible source. But Allah has sent you, O Muhammad, with the truth in which there is no doubt or confusion, which is to be given priority over all previous books and sayings.’ i ‘ij jSi’j ii’ iLio o^ tsQ cA>* ‘tj} i*.?,*’**»^ oi r. d*J 423. And never say of anything, “I shall do such and such thing tomorrow.”} 424. Except (with the saying), "If Allah wills!" And remember your Lord when you forget and say: "It may be that my Lord guides me to a nearer way of truth than this."} Saying “If Allah wills” when determining to do something in the future Here Allah, may He be glorified, shows His Messenger jfe the correct etiquette when determining to do something in the future; this should always be referred to the will of Allah, the m At-Tabari 17:642.

138 Tafslr Ibtî Kathîr Knower of the Unseen, Who knows what was and what is yet to be and what is not to be, and how it will be if it is to be. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said: tjjj - ol^il -JIUl iffei llflp SjIS ^ jUlîd, Ji»i) - j’jil jsb 14^1 ‘tMi J* J Jtf Z\jj - Jj jjj t jjl SH ?*•’ J>“*j 1jIwj —id*; ;f^ll V[jd; jju a5~f^ tdi>J p lii Jli oj Jii 3J t.Jl ^jJij “5. UU> jil j 1jjaUjD ifSulayman bin Dawud (peace be upon them both) said: “Tonight I will go around to seventy women [according to some reports, it was ninety or one hundred women] so that each one of them will give birth to a son who will fight for the sake of Allah.” It was said to him [according to one report, the angel said to him] “Say: ‘If Allah wills’”, but he did not say it. He went around to the women but none of them gave birth except for one who gave birth to a half-formed child.* The Messenger of Allah sg said, «Bt/ the One in Whose hand is my soul, had he said, "If Allah wills," he would not have broken his oath, and that would have helped him to attain what he wanted .» According to another report, *They would all have fought as horsemen in the cause of Allah . At the beginning of this Surah we discussed the reason why this Ayah was revealed: when the Prophet jg was asked about

the story of the people of the Cave, he said, “I will tell you

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3303–3347]

tomorrow.” Then the revelation was delayed for fifteen days.*2’ Since we discussed this at length at the beginning of the Surah, there is no need to repeat it here. ^C4_j ij[JZj iAnd remember your Lord when you forget ^ *** Fath Al-B&ri 6 :41 Muslim 3 :1275. [2i At-Tabari 17 :592

239 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (23-24) (Part-15) It was said that this means, if you forget to say “If Allah wills”, then say it when you remember. This was the view of Abu Al- ‘Aliyah and Al-Hasan Al-Basri. Hushaym reported from Al- A‘mash from Mujahid that concerning a man who swears an oath, Ibn

‘Abbas said “He may say If Allah wills’ even if it is a year later.” Ibn ‘Abbas used to interpret this Ayah: 4And remember your Lord token you forget} in this way. Al-A‘mash was asked, “Did you hear this from Mujahid?” He said, “Layth bin Abi Salim told it to me.”¹² * The meaning of Ibn ‘Abbas’ view, that a person may say “If Allah wills”, even if it is a year later, is that if he forgets to say it when he makes the oath or when he speaks, and he remembers it later, even a year later, the Sunnah is that he should say it, so that he will still be following the Sunnah of saying “If Allah wills”, even if that is after breaking his oath. This was also the view of Ibn Jarir,¹³¹ but he stated that this does not make up for breaking the oath or mean that one is no longer obliged to offer expiation. What Ibn Jarir said is correct, and it is more appropriate to understand the words of Ibn Abbas in this way. And Allah knows best. 'il iLia o' iiU'i Joli jl *jLiJ Zjiyu ~dj} 4And never say of anything, “I shall do such and such thing tomorrow.” Except (with the saying), “If Allah wills!” And remember your Lord when you forget} At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that this meant saying, “If Allah wills.”⁴¹ 4and say : "It may be that my Lord guides me to a nearer way of truth than this."} meaning, *if you (O Prophet) are asked about something you 111 At-Tabari 17:645. 121 At-Tabari 17:645. 131 At-Tabari 17:646. ' At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat7 :4545

241Surah 18. Al-Kahf (25-26) (Part-15) such as Mujahid and others among the earlier and later generations. iAnd they stayed in their cave three hundred years,} Qatadah said, this was the view of the People of the Book, and Allah refuted it by saying: i*4 4*\ ^Say : “Allah knows best how long they stayed.. .”} meaning, that Allah knows better than what the people say.’ 1 ’ This was also the view of Mutarraf bin ‘Abdullah. ’ However, this view is open to debate, because when the People of the Book said that they stayed in the cave for three hundred years, without the extra nine, they were referring to solar years, and if Allah was merely narrating what they had said, He would not have said, ^adding nine.} The apparent meaning of the Ayah is that Allah is stating the facts, not narrating what was said. This is the view of Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him). And Allah knows best. 4\ j£} iHcrw clearly He sees, and hears (everything)!} He sees them and hears them. Ibn Jarir said, “The language used is an eloquent expression of praise.”³ ’ The phrase may be understood to mean, how much Allah sees of everything that exists and how much He hears of everything that is to be heard, for nothing is hidden from Him! It was narrated that Qatadah commented on this Ayah: At-Tabari 17:647. >2 ’ At-Tabari 17:648. <3 ’ At-Tabari 17:650.

142 TafsTr Ibn Kathtr iHow clearly He sees, and hears (everything)!} “No one hears or sees more than Allah.”¹¹¹ iThey have no protector other than Him, and He makes none to share in His decision and His rule.} meaning, He, may He be glorified, is the One Who has the power to create and to command, the One Whose ruling cannot be overturned; He has no adviser, supporter or partner, may He be exalted and hallowed. J* Jol. V J* Jyl t> ff)} yi 2C1 js> y> ,4ij jjUjv |4ej cjif ^ j O* ^ ^ yj GjJt jj^jt lSj ij 4\$R\$ 427 . And recite what has beeti revealed to you (O Muhammad) of your Lord's Book. None can change His Words, and none will you find as refuge other than Him.} 428. And keep yourself (O Muhammad) patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon, seeking His Face; and let not your eyes overlook them, desiring the pomp and glitter of the life of the world; and obey not him whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance, and who follows his own lusts, and whose affair has been lost.} The Command to recite the Qur’an and to patiently keep Companywith the Believers Commanding His Messenger jg to recite His Holy Book and convey it to mankind, Allah says, iNone

can change His Words,} meaning, no one can alter them, distort them or misinterpret them. m At-Tabari 17:650.

243 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (27-28) (Part-15) Cft -*4 iand none ivill you find as a refuge other than Him> It was reported that Mujahid said, "A shelter," ' and that Qatadah said, "A helper or supporter." 12' Ibn Jarir said: "Allah is saying, 'if you O Muhammad, do not recite what is revealed to you of the Book of your Lord, then you will have no refuge from Allah.' "13 ' As Allah says: u> iifj oil; U Si iO Messenger! Proclaim (the Message) which has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind.^[5:67] ^ jjj[Ifjt iVerily, He Who has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the place of return. [28 :85] meaning, 'He will call you to account for the duty of conveying the Message which He entrusted you with.' \$And keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon, seeking His Face meaning, sit with those who remember Allah, who say "La Itaha niallah", who praise Him, glorify Him, declare His greatness and call on Him, morning and evening, all the servants of Allah, whether rich or poor, strong or weak. It was said that this was revealed about the nobles of Quraysh when they asked the Prophet si to sit with them on his own, and not to bring his weak Companions with him, such as Bilal, >" At-Tabari 17:651. At-Tabari 17 :651 131 At-Tabari 17:651.

Ammar, Suhayb, Khabbab and Ibn Mas*ud. They wanted him to sit with them on his own, but Allah forbade him from doing that, and said, <1 Yj) iAnd him not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and afternoon.) Allah commanded him to patiently content himself with sitting with those people (the weak believers), and said: iAnd keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon...) Imam Muslim recorded in his Sahih that Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas who said: "There was a group of six of us with the Prophet jg. The idolators said, Tell these people to leave so they will not offend us.' There was myself, Ibn Mastid, a man from Hudayl, Bilal and two other men whose names I have forgotten. Allah's Messenger sg thought to himself about whatever Allah willed he should think about, then Allah revealed: < > > .sit' -'"lit ~ iftrb Oy-Jj t/jJ' fji* jjy iAnd him not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and afternoon.) Only Muslim reported this; excluding Al-Bukhari.' 11 iand let not your eyes overlook them, desiring the pomp and glitter of the life of the world;) Ibn 'Abbas said, '(this means) do not favor others over them , meaning do not seek the people of nobility and wealth instead of them.' iand obey not him whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance) 111 Muslim 4:1878. At-Tabari 18:6.

TW iS&tmn means, those who are distracted by this world from being committed to the religion and from worshipping their Lord. iand whose affair (deeds) has been lost.) means, his actions and deeds are a foolish waste of time. Do not obey him or admire his way or envy what he has. As Allah says elsewhere: Uj!' Jyt) jVfi. u>j' = <: • ' : - •>' r. vi»*j yijj) aj 4A»d strain not your eyes in longing for the things We have given for enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them thereby. But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting> [20:131] LjJj cnUjiM txxl >Ci. «U . ; ^5v-3 o*, OiUi.j j!j UjjJ. jjJL_i!^ off "i' * 4J-j j3L-e.-Ot> 3j <->JAi/. ;TS ^ . . . ^ •- r* >> *> <• Sit *..* V- j[n] *Jfl^i y »/• yy- P **/* ^ » -'•/' /"J / ' (j""t ^ <29. And say: "The truth is from your Lord." Then whosoever wills, let him believe; and whosoever wills, let him disbelieve. Verily, We have prepared for the torongdoers, a Fire ivhose walls will be surrounding them. And if they

ask for drink, they will be granted water like Al-Muhl, that will scald their faces. Terrible is the drink, and an evil Murtafaq/\$>

147 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (29) (Part-15) Qat&dah said, "Ibn Mas'ud melted some gold in a grove, and when it became liquid and foam rose to the top, he said, this is the thing that is most like Al-Muhl."* 1 * Ad-Dahhak said: "The water of Hell is black, and it itself is black and its people are black."* 2 There is nothing contradictory in these comments, for Al-Muhl includes all of these unpleasant characteristics, it is black, evil-smelling, thick and hot, as Allah said, 4[it] will scald their faces .^ meaning because of its heat. When the disbeliever wants to drink it and brings it close to his face, it will scald it so that the skin of his face falls off into it. Said bin Jubayr said, "When the people of Hell get hungry, they will ask for relief from it, and they will be given the tree of Zaqqum from which they will eat. The tree will tear off the skin of their faces, and if anyone who knew them were to pass by, he would recognize the skin of their faces in the tree. Then they will feel thirsty, so they will ask for drink, and they will be granted water like Al-Muhl, that is what has been heated to the ultimate temperature. When it is brought near their mouths, the flesh of their faces from which the skin has been torn off will be baked."* 3 ' After describing this drink in these horrifying qualities, Allah says: ^Terrible is the drink, meaning, how awful this drink is. Similarly, He says in another Ayah 4 tLf it iand be given to drink boiling water so that it cuts up their bowels .) [47:15] iThey will be given to drink from a boiling spring.) [88:5] _____m At-Tabari 18:13. At-Tabari 18:13. ' At-Tabari 18:14.

149 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (30-31) (Part-15) 4they will be adorned} means, with jewelry. AJ* ->J J!\$ If,^ Awith bracelets of gold,} Allah says elsewhere: fvo; Si 4and pearls and their garments therein will be of silk} (22:23|. This is explained in more detail here, where Allah says: A£P£ Cu >££} }and they will wear green garments of Sundus and Istabraq.} Sundus refers to a fine garment, like a shirt and the like, and Istabraq is thick and shiny velvet. je IJj U0-*} AThey will be Muttaki'in therein on Ara'ik. The word Muttaki'in implies lying down, or it was said that it means sitting with one's legs crossed, which is closer to the meaning here. In a Sahih Hadith, the Prophet jg said: jf? Sti ui «As for me, I do not eat sitting with legs crossed (Muttaki'an)'». Ara'ik is the plural of Arikah, which is a bed under a canopy. And Allah knows best. AHow good is the reward, and what an excellent place of rest (Murtafaq)! } means, how blessed is Paradise as a reward for their good deeds. And what an excellent Murtafaq means, and how good a place to dwell and rest and stay. Previously, Allah had said of Hell, Jj ATerrible is the drink, and an evil place of rest (Murtafaq)!} [18:29]. PI Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :557

The Example of the Rich Idolators and the Poor Muslims After mentioning the idolators who were too arrogant to sit with the poor and weak among Muslims, showing off before them with their wealth and noble lineage, Allah then gives a parable for them of two men, one of whom Allah gave two gardens of grapes, surrounded with palm trees and cultivated with crops throughout. All of the trees and plants were abundantly fruitful, providing readily accessible, good quality produce. Allah says: i<0\ 0# (%) iEach of those two gardens brought forth its produce,} meaning, produced its fruits, %} iand failed not in the least therein,} meaning, nothing at all was diminishing. 4& £«% iand We caused a river to gush forth in the midst of both.} means, rivers were flowing through them here and there. 42 /» iAnd he had Thamar,} It was said that what was meant here was wealth, and it was said that what was meant were fruits, which is the more apparent meaning here. This is also supported by the alternative recitation,

Thumr, which is the plural of Thamrah (fruit) just as Khushb is the plural of Khashab (wood). Others recite it as Thamar. 4'M iand he said} the owner of the two gardens 4£jj(k .*^J} ito his companion in the course of discussion} means, while he was disputing with him and boasting to him and showing off, m At-Tabari 18:21.

i&>% ft il am greater than you in wealth and have a mightier entourage.} meaning, 1 have more servants, attendants and children.' Qatadah said, "This, by Allah, is the wish of the immoral to have a lot of wealth and a large entourage. 4'irr^ . pJ-i '£> j'~*j} AAnd he went into his garden having been unjust to himself.} meaning, in his disbelief, rebellion, arrogance and denial of the Hereafter. itJuA JL*» J DA Z &} AHe said: "1 do not think this will ever perish."} Thus he was allowing himself to be deceived because of the plants, fruits and trees that he saw, and the rivers flowing through the different parts of his gardens. He thought that it could never come to an end or cease or be destroyed. This was because of his lack of understanding and the weakness of his faith in Allah, and because he was enamored with this world and its adornments, and because he disbelieved in the Hereafter. So he said: A"And I do not think the Hour will ever come..."} meaning, will ever happen l+L by- olfV if) til OjjJ Aand if indeed I am brought back to my Lord, I surely shall find better than this when I return to Him.} meaning, *if there is a Hereafter and a return to Allah,, then I will have a better share than this with my Lord, for if it were not that I am dear to Him, He would not have given me all this.' As Allah says elsewhere: fSst; if ol iff) <J' odj} m At-Tabari 18:22.

iBut if I am brought back to my Lord, surely there will be for me the best with Him [41:50] lliilij jiJrr=> ,Jjt O. i <(\$&& ju; iHave you seen him who disbelieved in Our Ayat and said: "1 shall certainly be given wealth and children [if I will be alive again).">[19:77] He took it for granted that Allah would give him this, without any sound evidence for that. The reason why this Ayah was revealed was because of Al- 'As bin Wa'il, as we will explain in the appropriate place, if Allah wills. In Allah we put our trust. jr *> i'i'i' ** i' ** >> '-4J»QipL-liu \&-oju-V />/ ^ O .y y ^yy.' jTtji/^iilili.cSjJlCi/O I - >£vjJJ '-^3^4^Sfj ^ 5'jjJo! -. 15 1 *1 •^ . 1 - U . ' > } . / y' < y < iii ,s'." <.y " ^La_»3u>i6l3j^«3 L>iL.Jil C| p\ fjJb 0.-wj' <J?jd i ~ -il ^ a4j Vil'-wU JL^LijJl ,^,5U) Jiy_ Jr <iL ^ yl_P .>? lillli. isJij CJ^"i iyjU / 4».lS ,J »jS V ii' *Li Ci >lii iiCl*- 3jLi i[VjJJ 'rVlju-l (£} J^ 'j jj ii> j-tJJ at fc-* 3j>i ^ Gj df-*5 t'. '-Ji) VC» iiLr Jii t' 0^_J jl <il V] \$ CsJU jyi' jl i; ;U!> .CU' ,ji (;C_1»- l^pL^U 437. His companion said to him during his discussion: "Do you disbelieve in Him Who created you out of dust, then out of Nutfah , then fashioned you into a man?"} ** A drop of sperm. Usually used to refer to the mixture of the male and female discharge

4^ iand none shall I associate as partner with my Lord.} meaning, He is Allah, the One Who is to be worshipped Alone, with no partner or associate. Then he said: VI* jii Li' oj-j aLi V! ijjs V «i' »Li U ^ i' 4It was better for you to say, when you entered your garden, 'That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah!' If you see me less than you in wealth, and children.} Here he was urging and encouraging him to say that, as if he was saying, "When you entered your garden and looked at it and liked it, why would'nt you praise Allah for the blessings He gave you and the wealth and children that He has given to you and not to others? Why did you not say That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah!?" " One of the Salaf said, "Whoever is delighted with something in his circumstances or his wealth or his children, let him say, That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah!' " This

is based on this Ayah. It was reported in the Sahih from Abu Musa that the Messenger of Allah said: *ajil. V| iy Vj jy- V jfS^ -S Jj. i&{ Vb 'Shall I not tell you about some of the treasure of Paradise? La hawla wa Id quwwata ilia billah (There is no power or might but with Allah) .» ,li 4^~»r Jt 3 4It may be that my Lord will give me something better than your garden,} in the Hereafter iand will send on it} on your garden in this world, which you think will never come to an end or cease to be, 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :217, Muslim 4 :2076.*

ui iHusban from the sky,) Ibn 'Abbas, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah' said - emd Malik narrated that Az-Zuhri said - a punishment from heaven. The apparent meaning is that it is a mighty rain which would disrupt his garden and uproot its plants and trees. As he said: 4then it will be as a barren slippery earth.) meaning, smooth mud in which one cannot get a foothold. Ibn 'Abbas said, "Like land without vegetation, where nothing grows. ",21 4£3® iOr the water thereofbecomes Ghawran) means, it disappears into the earth, which is the opposite of flowing water that seeks the surface of the earth. So Gha'ir is to go lower, as Allah says: iSay: "Tell me! If your water were Ghawran, who then can supply you withflowing water?") [67:30] meaning, water that flows in all directions. And here Allah says: 4i & ujt y4 40r the water thereof (of the gardens) becomes deep-sunken (underground) so that you will never be able to seek it.) Ghawr is from the same root as Gha'ir and has a similar meaning, but is more intensive. J Jyy d® Jp E d® 442. So his fruits were encircled (with ruin). And began Yuqallibu his hands over what he had spent upon it, while it At-Tabari 18:25. At-Tabari 18:26.

157Surah 18. Al-Kahf (42-44) (Part-15 was all destroyed on its trellises, and he could only say: "Would that I had ascribed no partners to my Lord!") }43 . And he had no group of men to help him against Alldlt, nor could he defend (or save) himself.} 444. There (on the Day of Resurrection), Al-Waldyah ivill be for Allah (Alone), the True God. He (Allah) is the best for reivard and the bestfor thefinal end.} The Evil Results ofKufr Allah says: 4So his fruits were encircled}, meaning his wealth, or according to the other opinion, his crops. What is meant is that what this disbeliever was afraid ofand what the believer had terrified him actually had happened. A storm struck his garden, a garden which he had erroneously thought would last forever, distracting him from thoughts of Allah, may He be glorified. 4£ && *2p\} 4And he began Yuqallibu his hands over what he had spent upon it,} Qatadah said: "He was clasping his hands together in gesture of regret and grief for the wealth he had lost." 4 ^ j*b j <j&^ . 3yti} 4and he could only say: "Would that I had ascribed no, partners to my Lord!" And he had no group ofmen} [l meaning a clan or children, as he had vainly boasted, 4'\$s k Cj2 ok oe 4to help him against Allah, nor could he defend himself. There, Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God. Here there are differences in recitation. Some of the reciters pause at the word there, 4Mlk;^k Cj} m At-Tabari 18:27.

inor could he defend himself there.}, i.e., at that time, when Allah sends the punishment upon him, there will be no one to save him. Then they start the next phrase with Al-Walayah; 4Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God.} Some of them pause at the phrase 4: Cj} 4nor could he defend himself} and start the next phrase; 4\$ i-f m ijf Safi} iTitere, Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God.} There is a further difference in the recitation of the word Al- Walayah. Some read it as Al-Walayah, which gives the meaning that all allegiance will be to Allah, i.e., on that Day everyone, believer or disbeliever, will return to Allah, for allegiance and submission to Him when the punishment comes to pass. This is like

the Ayah: i&Z&Z }SZ k\ ijSli j& ££} 4So when they saw Our punishment, they said: "We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as partners."} [40:84] and Allah says concerning the Fir'awn; j* Siir-l Ir*. 'ii CfjJ' VJ j» iJjJf JS TiJ iTill when drowning overtook him, he said: "/ believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims." Now! While you refused to believe before and you were one of the mischief-makers . 10:90-9 1] Some others read it as Al-Wilayah, meaning that on that Day the rule will belong to Allah, the True God. Some read Haqu (True) refering to Al-Wilayah, as in the Ayah-, Jp Ly» (jl£==y V't:v 4The sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty).

159Surah 18. Al-Kahf (45-46) (Part-15) belonging to the Most Gracious (Allah), and it will be a hard Dayfor the disbelievers [25:26). Others it read Haqqi referring to Allah, may He be glorified, as in the Ayah: iThen they are returned to Allah, their True Protector.} (6:62) So Allah says: 4C** C'_P 5*. 4He (Allah) is the best to reward and the best for the final end.} for deeds that were done for the sake of Allah, their reward is good and their consequences are all good. 'id JaUa-U .iT lij)' 5** ip* Vi lllJJ' KmJ Oyjfj Jllii !J ijXii oJjX d „-sY\ iV 445. And mention the parable of the worldly life: it is like the water which We send down from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter. And Allah is able to do everything . } 446. Wealth and children are the adornment of the life of this world. But the good righteous deeds that last, are better with your Lordfor reward and betterfor hope.} The Parable ofthe Worldly Life Allah says: iAnd mention} O Muhammad, to the people, 4Q!i\ ip-' &} 4the parable of the worldly life}, its transient nature and how will eventually cease and come to an end. ijfiiP* iPS Sii# it

161Surah 18. Al-Kahf (45-46) (Part-15) .A ->- Uilll «77iis world is sweet and green. i Between Wealth and Good Deeds ju^ 4Wealth and children are the adornment of the life of this world. } This is like the Ayah f^ ScJfj t^)>^ 4^ u£j iBeautified for men is the love of things they covet; women, children, vaulted hoards ofgold... [3:14], Allah says: %h -fitf 'a> iYour wealth and your children are only a trial, ivhereas Allah! With Him is a great reward (Paradise).} [64:15] turning towards Allah and worshipping Him is better for you than keeping busy with them, and accumulating wealth for them and going to extremes in feeling pity and compassion for them. Allah says: UjS 'Ay x* jf- 0^*4^ 4But the good righteous deeds that last, are better with your Lordfor reward and betterfor hope.} Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and others among the Salaf said that the good righteous deeds that last are the five daily prayers.,2) 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah and Said bin Jubayr narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, "The good righteous deeds that last are 'Subhan Allah (glory be to Allah)', 'Al-Hamdu LiUah (praise be to Allah)', 'Ld ilaha iUalldh (there is none worthy of worship except Allah)', and 'Allahu Akbar (Allah is Most Great).'" The Commander of the faithful, 'Uthman bin 'Affan was 111 Muslim 4 :2098 121 At-Tabari 18:32. At-Tabari 18:33.

questioned, "Which are the good righteous deeds that last?" He replied, "They are: 'Ld ildha illalldh, Subhdn Allah, Al- Hamdu Lilldh, Allahu Akbar and Ld hawla wa la quwwata ilia billah hti-'Aliyil-'Azim (there is no strength and no power except with Allah the Exalted, the Almighty).'" This was recorded by Imam Ahmad . Imam Ahmad also recorded from a freed slave of the Messenger of Allah sjg that he said: ijiil Jfs\ iilj Jil Vi ill V : ^ y 2? C? _ _ yyi i aJ'Jij i4i xLDj 'j&O :2>JI jf, ibi @^ 1 JLiU Lij «We// done! Well done for five things! (Hoiv heavy they will weigh in the balance! "La ildha

illalldh, Allahu Akbar, Subhdn Allah, and Al-Haitidu Lilldh," and a righteous son zvho dies and his parents seek the rezvard ofAllah.* And he said: "We// done! Well done for five things! Whoever meets Allah believing in them, he zoill enter Paradise; ifhe believes in Allah, the Last Day, Paradise and Hell, resurrection after death, and the Reckoning*P ithe good righteous deeds that last,) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This is the celebration of the remembrance of Allah, saying 'Ld ildha illalldh, Allahu Akbar, Subhdn Allah, Al-Hamdu Lilldh, Tabarak Allah, Ld hawla wa la quwwata ilia billah, Astaghfirallah , Sallalldhu 'aid Rasul-Allah', and fasting, prayer, Hajj, Sadaqah (charity), freeing slaves, Jihad, maintaining ties of kinship, and all other good deeds. These are the righteous good deeds that last, which will remain in Paradise for those who do them for as long as heaven and earth remain."131 Al-'AwfI reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "They are Ahmad 1:71. Ahmad 4 :237 At-Tabari 18:35.

mmw \,good words." JjjXypw\$ • > 'i' , ' ' -t rr *#&&&\$(&0'Usjjj4J *!-' / / / / > > / / * > UJl*JULiLjjOjSjiy ~<J'>-*'V^o_ / ^Sfjajyw> \Jo-\ijJj 1/vjL- &>,, .Vi ••*" • > '." \ # \$ v'IEa*14Bji ufj^ rv, ? >.' {>"•" <&s, pAj^Ad dyjJ'e£ jUiSjUJl 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "They are all righteous deeds."121 This was also the view chosen by Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercyon him. *A»sM <4/j JCb fj»uT •j> - ,•> :: •>•" .- jjU |^» »«j^< li_0 tilij £# cr^ J J**? J 1 ji "" > 'tXt ' ,r' ,••: i£/A <_ «' ' .So ..tA u~4 >J)Yi *.• Uia ju '•' t / Vj jjliu V t. U V | i/!^" ciUj jltnu]^>L. jlj*£ f;S;65 O^jiy And (remember) the Day We shall cause the mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a levelled plain, and We shall gather them so that We will leave not one of than behind. 448. And they will be set before your Lord, aligned. (He ivill say :) "Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time. Nay, but you thought that We had appointed no meetingfor you (with Us).") 449. And the Book ivill be produced, and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is therein. They will say: "Woe 111 At-Tabari 18:35. At-Tabari 18:35.

165Surah 18. Al-Kahf (47-49) (Part-15 will be visible to their Lord, and not one of them will ibe hidden from Him. Mujahid and Qatadah said, iU 4and you will see the earth as a levelled plain, "No one will be hidden or absent." * Qatadah said, "There ViU be no buildings and no trees."*2 40 (£*0 f iand we shall gather them, so that We will not leave one them behind.) means, *We shall gather them all, the first of them and the last of them, and We shall not leave anyone behind, young or old.' As Allah says: 4Say: "(yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. Ah will surely be gathered together for an appointed meeting of <| known Day.) [56:49,50] 4U2 }y. S&j pim 4That is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, antjf that is a Day when all will be present} [1 1:103]. iAnd they will be set before your Lord, aligned.} This may mean that all of creation will stand before Allah one row, as Allah says: 4@t^& &)' 24 Z% b \$%0 4The Day that Ar-Rilh (Jibrtl) and the angels will stand aligned, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (Allah) allows, and he will speak what is right} [78:38]; or it may mean that they will stand in rows, as Allah says: in I 1 * At-Tabari 18:36. * At-Tabari 18:36.

iAnd your Lord comes ivith the angels in rmvs. j» (89:221 <£ 3} iNow indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time.} This is a rebuke to those who denied the Hereafter, a reprimand before all creation. This is why Allah says to them: iNay, but you thought that We had appointed no meeting for you (with Us).}, meaning, you did not think that this would happen to you or that it would come to

pass. idKfi gjj} iAnd the Book will be produced,} the Book of deeds, which contains a record of everything, major or minor, significant or insignificant, great or small. iand you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is therein.} of their evil deeds and reprehensible actions. CiJyij} iTitey will say, "Woe to us!"} expressing words of regret for having wasted their lives. 4U Vi Jill f Uift 3ft} iWhat sort of Book is this tlwt leaves neither a small thing nor a large thing, but has recorded it with numbers!} it has left no sin, major or minor, and no action, no matter how small, but it has recorded it with the utmost precision and accuracy. ijL* u ijoiij} iAnd they will find all that they did, present,} everything, both good and evil, as Allah says, •J * y ^ i > ^ ^ ^ \

iOn the Day when every person will be confronted with all the good he has done} [3:30]. Allah says: fj* fry. iOn that Day man will be informed of ivhat he sent forward, and what he left behind.} [75:13] And Allah says: j?0 iThe Day when all the secrets will be exposed.} [86:9] meaning, everything that is hidden in people's hearts will become known. Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas that the Prophet jg said, «Every traitor will have a banner on the Day of Resurrection, by which he ivill be knmvn.^ 1 ^ It was also narrated in the Two Sahths, where one narration J, o'ji ijJi- ojlii : JLf jJi -fr; iilliJl fy tji j>d- j£i "On the Day of Resurrection, for every traitor a banner ivill bt erected by his backside, and it will be said, "This is the betrayer ofso-and-so the son ofso-and-so."n121 / /"I <" 1 . a [siiij z&i Vj} iand your Lord treats no one with injustice.} means, He will judge between His creatures for all of their deeds, and He will not treat any of His creatures \yith injustice. He will overlook and forgive and have mercy, and He will punish whomever He wills by His power, wisdom and justice. He will fill Hell with the disbelievers and those who have been disobedient. Then He will rescue the disobedient, Ahmad 3 :142 121 Fath Al-Bari 12 :354, Muslim 3 :1361

and leave the disbelievers there for eternity. He is the Judge Who never wrongs or oppresses. Allah says: jrj yyt JtiL <t ^ji iSurehj, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good, He doubles it> [4:40] iAnd We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything.} Until His saying; ito take account [21:47] And there are many similar Ayat. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Muhammad bin 'Aqll heard Jabir bin 'Abdullah say, "I was told about a Hadith which a man heard from the Prophet jg, so I bought a camel and put my saddle on it, then I traveled on it for a month until I came to Ash-Sham,^ * where 'Abdullah bin Unays was. I said to the doorkeeper, Tell him that Jabir is at the door.' He said, 'Jabir bin 'Abdullah?' I said, 'Yes.' So he came out, still putting his garment on, and embraced me, and I embraced him, and said: 1 heard a Hadith narrated by you, that you heard from the Messenger of Allah 3^5 about reciprocal punishments. I was afraid that you or I would die before I could hear it.' He said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah sg say: Yji- lYjC. - SlUJl :JU j\ - iilliJl ^01 JJ-j Jp 4)1 ytj "Allah will gather the people - or His servants - on the Day of Resurrection, naked, uncircumcised and Buhman . » I asked, "What is Buhman?" He said, i-{ • I ' <r \ _ • - • * * * . \ • >" , *ib ' if UO Oaj -jA yjli p-fOUJ pj i p \$ < 1 if ^ if V jljjJl l5l i J*' ji <jfri Yj iO -wol j>- iLjJI jii 111 Greater Syria

169Surah 18. Al-Kahf (50) (Part-15) j* J4-3 ^4 ^3 «They will have nothing with them. Then a voice ivill call out to them that will be heard by those far away just as easily as it will be heard by those near: "I am the Sovereign, I am the fudge. None of the people of Hell should enter Hell if he is owed something by one of the people of Paradise, until I have settled the matter, and none of the people of

Paradise should enter Paradise if he is owed something by one of the people of Hell, until I settle the matter - even if it is only the case of a slap." » We said, 'How will that be, when we have come before Allah barefooted, naked, uncircumcised and having nothing with us?' He said, [merit for] good deeds, and [recompense] for evil deeds .»| Shuhah narrated from Al-'Awwam bin Muzahim from Abu 'Uthman from 'Uthman bin 'Affan, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah jg said: «77?e animal who lost a horn will settle the score with the one that has horns on the Day of Resurrection .»|21 It was recorded by 'Abdullah the son of Imam Ahmad, a there are corroborating narrations through other routes. nd *i> s i je- Csi o? J-Q ^ J lii OjAJiU, ->*** Oi '-Jji' i50. And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves unto Adam." So they prostrated themselves, except Iblis. He was one of the Jinn; he disobeyed the command of his Lord. Will you then take him and his offspring as protectory and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers.} Ahmad 3:495. ' Zawa'id Al-Musnad, 1:12.

170 Tafsir Ibtt Kathlr The Story of Adam and Iblis Allah points out to the Children of Adam the enmity of Iblis towards them and their father before them, and rebukes those who follow him and go against their Creator and Master. It is He who created them from nothing and sustains and nourishes them by His kindness, yet they still took Iblis as their friend and declared their enmity towards Allah. So Allah says: Gfi>0 iAnd (remember) when We said to the angels}, meaning all the angels, as was mentioned in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. W iProstrate yourselves unto Adam} a prostration of respect and honour, as Allah says: Z& % p. a pZ. » £2 && & x 10 A -L* , * -i . /J j*** jrju ot iAnd (remember) when your Lord said to the angels, "1 am going to create a human (Adam) from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud. So, when I have fashioned him completely and breathed into him the soul which I created for him, then fall (you) down prostrating yourselves unto him.} [15:28-29] 4So they prostrated themselves except Iblis . He was one of the Jinn;} meaning, his original nature betrayed him. He had been created from smokeless fire, whereas the angels had been created from light, as is stated in Sahih Muslim where it is reported that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said that the Messenger of Allah sjg said: it; fSl jIJ>-j lJU ^A £jU JA J A •jJS HI See volume one, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Baqarah 2:36.

«The angels were created from light, Iblis was created from smokeless fire, and Adam was created from that ivhich has been described to you .»[1 When matters are crucial, every vessel leaks that which it contains and is betrayed by its true nature. Iblis used to do what the angels did and resembled them in their devotion and worship, so he was included when they were addressed, but he disobeyed and went against what he was told to do. 'So Allah points out here that he was one of the Jinn, i.e., he was created from fire, as He says elsewhere: \$1 am better than he. You created me from fire, and Yowl created him from c/ay.^[38:76] Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "Iblis was not one of the angels, not even for a second. He was the origin of the Jinn just as Adajm, upon him be peace, was the origin of mankind." This was narrated by Ibn Jaiir with a Sahih chain.12 ' s& ihe disobeyed the command of his Lord .} meaning by stepping beyond the bounds of obedience to Allah. Fisq (disobeying) implies going out or stepping beyond. When the date emerges from its flower, the verb used in Arabic^ is Fasaqat, the same verb is used to describe a mouse coming out of its hole when it comes out to do damage. Then Allah says, rebuking those who follow and obey Iblis: iWill you then take him and his offspring as protectors am helpers rather than Me} meaning, instead of Me. This is why Allah says: ill JL} iWhat an evil is the

exchange for the wrongdoers.} This is like the Ayah in Surah Yd Sin where, after mentioning I 1 * Muslim 4 :2294 121 At-Tabari 18:506.

if* jji [/;;»*,j .Jtt (UjAAi O^' b-5^ Jyi fjo¥ 41^4^* V* b-1^ . pb ^*Ab* oyj£& '»o> 452. And (remember) the Day He will say: "Call those (so- called) partners of Mine whom you claimed." Then they will cry unto them, but they will not answer them, and We shall put Mawbiq between them.} 453. And the criminals shall see the Fire and apprehend that they are to fall therein. And they will find no way of escape from it.) Their Partners are notable to respond and the Criminals are brought to the Fire Allah tells us how He will address the idolaters on the Day of Resurrection before all of creation, rebuking and scolding them, 4^0 iCall those (so-called) partners of Mine whom you claimed.) meaning, in the world. Call them today to save you from the situation you are in! Allah says: l*j |^=y>«k *bj p£ £lj>- U // Jj! fSjli- IT Zsfji iAnd truly, you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time. You have left what you were given behind your backs and We do see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed were your partners. Now all relations between you and them have been cut off, and all that you used to claim has vanished from you.) [6:94] iThen they will cry unto them, but they will not answer them.) As Allah says:

4And it will be said (to them) : "Call upon those partners of yours," then they will call upon them, but they will not answer them .} (28:64) And the Ayah : 4\$ ^ A ?»' oA Crt 'S-A f-t Aj} 4And who is more astray than one ivlio calls others besides Allah, such as ivill not answer him^ (46:5) Until the end of the two Ayat, they have taken gods besides Allah, that they may grant them honor. Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.)> (19:81-82) iand We shall put Matobiq between them.} Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and others said: "Destruction."1 ' 1 The meaning is that Allah is stating that these idolaters will have no way of reaching the gods they claimed in this world. He will separate them in the Hereafter and neither party will have any means of reaching the other. There will be devastation, great horrors and other terrible things in between them. 'Abdullah bin 'Amr understood the pronoun in the phrase "between them" to refer to the believers and the disbelievers,121 meaning that the people of guidance and the people of misguidance will be separated. This then is like the Ayab 4 fju0} 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated.} (30:14) iOn that Day men shall be divided.} [30:43], At-Tabari 18:46. AkTabari 18:46.

<\$ }# !££\$> 4(It will be said), "And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day (from the believers).} [36:59] si ill&?t*fim 4And on the Day when We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who joined partners, "Stop in your place! You and your partners." T\en We shall separate between them... until, t^&} 4And what they invented will vanish from them.} [10:28-30] [)*£ jU_> oy jj} 4And the criminals shall see the Fire and apprehend that they are to fall therein. And they will find no way of escape from it.} meaning when they see Hell with their own eyes, since it is being dragged forth by seventy thousand reins, each pulled by seventy thousand angels. When, oy_fiS\ ^jj} 4the criminals shall see the Fire}, they will realize that they cannot escape being thrown into it, and that will only intensify their anxiety and distress, because the anticipation and fear of punishment is in itself a real punishment. \$j} 4And they will find no way of escape from it.} means, they will have no way of fleeing, it will be inevitable. uKj JS* ^'r-a J* til* J) llir*> 454. And indeed We have given every kind of example in this Qur'an for mankind. But, man is ever more quarrelsome than anything.}

Examples put forth in the Qur'an Allah says, In this Qur'an, We have explained to mankind and given clear details of matters so that they will not stray from the truth or be misled from the path of guidance. Despite this explanation, man is very quarrelsome and opposes truth with falsehood,' except for those whom Allah guides to the path of salvation. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Ali bin Abi Talib said that the Messenger of Allah came to visit him and Fatimah, the daughter of Allah's Messenger at night, and said, 'f» 4Are you not going to pray?} I said, "O Messenger of Allah, our souls are in the Hand of Allah. If He wills to wake us, He will wake us." When I said that, he went away without returning. Then I heard him as he was walking away, slapping his thigh and saying, & JiJ 4But, man is ever more quarrelsome than anything•K' It was also recorded in the Two Sahihs.m f jJjV' ili. <j1^ 1 o' £- '4 aji *1&U« 4 <VJfa bjjj' Ij 3^ *» 455. And nothing prevents men from believing, while the guidance has come to them, andfrom askingforgiveness of their Lord, except that the ways of the ancients be repeated with them, or the torment be brought to them face toface.} 456. And We send not the Messengers except as bearers of good news and wamers. But those who disbelieve, argue ivith falsehood, in order to refute the truth thereby. And tliey take My Ayat and that which they are warnedfor jest!} 111 Ahmad 1:112. 121 Fath Al-Bari 3:13, Muslim 1 :538.

177Surah 18. Al-Kahf (55-56) (Part-15 The Rebellion ofthe Disbelievers Allah tells us about the rebellion of the disbelievers in ancient times and in more recent times, and how they rejected tne obvious truth even when they witnessed clear signs and proofs. Nothing stopped them from following the truth except their demand to witness with their own eyes the punishmejnt which they were being warned about. As some of them said to their Prophet: {HiJi Lile jii—*li^ 4So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!} [26:187], Others said: 4 vJjuu iBring Allah's torment upon us ifyou are one of the truthful.} [29:29] The Quraysh said: oil ; £3J ^ h* « > fo 4^} ' * > 40 Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain doum stones on usfrom the sky or bring upon us a painful torment .} [8:32] * 4 ul- C j ;T:S£^4 ^ 4And they say : "O you to whom the Reminder has been sent down! Verily, you are a mad man! Why do you not bring angels to us ifyou are of the truthful?"} [15:6-7], There are other Ayat refering to the same thing. Then Allah says: 4'j0 o'1 iexcept that the ways of the ancients be repeated with them,} meaning, their overwhelming punishment, destroying every last one of them.

4>0uJ' ior the tortnent be brought to themface toface.} they see it with their own eyes, being directly confronted with it. Then Allah says: iAnd We send not the Messengers except as bearers of good news and wamers.} before the punishment they give good news to those who believe in them and follow them, and warnings to those who reject them and oppose them. Then Allah tells us about the disbelievers who argue: iwith falsehood, in order to refute the truth thereby.} they tiy to weaken the truth that the Messengers brought, but they cannot achieve that. i& Cj } iAnd they take My Aydt and that which they are warned for jest! } they take the proof, evidence and miracles sent with the Messengers to warn them, and make them fear the punishment; ias a jest and mockery} and they make fun of them, which is the worst type of disbelief. lil c-Ji £ jfff) jJK '£)} 'Mil) =v , (jti Xjj •jftii J Vxj.. £ l&x p. i£35. C r&a&Z 13 tf\$£& Mb « 457. And who does more wrong than he who is reminded of the Aydt (signs) of his Lord, but turns away from them, forgetting what his hands have sent forth. Truly, VV e have set aver their hearts Akinnah, lest they should understand this (the Qur'an),

and in their ears, deafness. And if you call them to guidance, even then they will never be guided.} 458. And your Lord is Most Forgiving, Owner of mercy. Were He to call than to account for what they have earned, then surely, He would have hastened their punishment . But they have their appointed time, beyond which they will find no escape .} 459. And these towns, We destroyed them when they did wrong. And We appointed a fixed timefor their destruction .} The Worst People are Those Who turn away after being reminded Allah says, Who among My creatures does more wrong than one who is reminded of the signs of Allah then turns av/ay from them,' i.e., ignores them and does not listen or pay attention to them. ik C^} 4forgetting what his hands have saltforth.} means, bad deeds and evil actions. 4Tndy, We have set over their hearts} means, the hearts of these people, 4Z4J} 4Akimtah} means, coverings. 4lest they should understand this,} means, so that they will not understand this Qur'an and its clear Message ifjj 4and in their ears, deafness.} means that they will be deaf in an abstract way, to guidance. iQ i'h£££ jl J&e oH} 4And ifyou call them to guidance, even then they ivill never be guided.}

180 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr JJHii 4And your Lord is Most Forgiving, Owner ofmercy.^ means, "your Lord, O Muhammad, is forgiving and has great mercy.' ^IVere He to call them to account for what they have earned, then surely, He would have hastened their punishment. } This is like the Ayah: 4&Z oi jc dip u [iiit 4And 1 / Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth.} [35:45] j34 ^ frji ^ 10 4Bnf verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment} [13:6], And there are many Ayatwhich say the same thing. Then Allah tells us that He is patient, He conceals faults and forgives sins. He may guide some of them from wrongdoing to true guidance, and whoever continues in his evil ways, then there will come to him a Day when infants will turn grey and every pregnant female will shed her load. He says: Oi J 00 iBut they have their appointed time, beyond which they will find no escape.} meaning, they will find no way out. 4And these towns, We destroyed them when they did wrong.} This refers to earlier nations in times past; "We destroyed them because of their stubborn disbelief.' £"0 }And We appointed a fixed timefor their destruction.}

u2R!jSS % L*J Vj*.fjrjJsP io>Vi -rr f ->-r " .If-f *•>-• 5- . I'-.IU, li '^ »/V » 1* A A _ I A f > . Itv^ 0_) (j * a J.iJ 4i\$ <£#&44^4; JSi j) iiii<y_^J6irj^ , <£*^ ,>> ^ -"f.f ""'•ft'--" •-'-'>< L»uLa-A—S \>C4*J»**• «i_i) <^ . -:r • >f •' >t"<i" ~ 'We appointed for them a set time limit, not to be increased or decreased. The same applies to you, O ico lators, so beware or what happened to them will happen to you too, for you have rejected the noble st Messenger ar.d greatest Prophet, aid you are not dearer to Us than them, so fear My punishment and wrath.' 'j jfi jj >-l &p ^ Up jl Ij i. l 1 .- ' |Ujf Ljllj is j js*. jGIs qfc jis ££ llu fjtpjt^ bnu- |^4 L_JJ -li! U»L& lilt ot o'Wr .ill 4_^il L_j ojil i^j jli fcjl jli Vila iju.y USjS ji*& U Jili jte iJfjCe 4 ^*0 GjJ C>i liJi£ 6; A.* ASjill "Gallic >; 460. And (remember) when Musa said to his boy-servant: "I will not give up until I reach the junction of the two seas or a Huqub passes."} 462 . But when they reached the junction of the two seas, they forgot their fish, and it took its way through the sea as in a tunnel.} 462. So when they passed further on, Musa said to his boy- servant: "Bring us our morning meal; truly, we have suffered

182 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Nasaban in this, ourjourney."} 463. He said: "Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? 1 indeed forgot the fish; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it. It took its course into the sea in a strange (way)!"} 464. [Musa] said: "That is what we have been seeking." So

they went back retracing their footsteps.} 465. Then they found one of Our servants, on whom We had bestowed mercy from Us, and whom We had taught knowledge from Us.} The Story of Musa and Al-Khidr

The reason for Musa's conversation with the boy-servant,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3347–3360]

Yusha' bin Nun, was that he had been told about one of the servants of Allah at the junction of the two seas, who had knowledge which Musa had not been granted, so he wanted to travel to meet him. So he said to that boy-servant of his: 41 will not give up} meaning, I will keep on traveling, 4until I reach the junction of the two seas} meaning, the place where the two seas met. 4tj£- \$} 4or a Huqub passes.} meaning, even if I have to travel for a very long time. Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him) said, "Some of the scholars of the Arabic language said that Huqub means a year in the dialect of [the tribe of] Qays," * then he narrated that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "Huqub means eighty years."*2 Mujahid said, "Seventy years."*3 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that it means a lifetime.14 * Qatadah and At-Jabari 18:56. At-Jabari 18:56. * At-Tabari 18:56. * At-Tabari 18:57.

Ibn Zayd said likewise.111 Cj L j'.u Ljij \Lt} tu/ien they reacted the junction of the two seas, they forgot their fish,} He had been commanded to carry a salted fish with him, and it had been said to him, when you lose the fish, that will be a sign that you have reached the right place. So they set out and traveled until they reached the junction of the two seas, where there was a spring called 'Ayn Al-Hayat (the Spring of Life). They went to sleep there, and the fish felt the drops of that water, so it came back to life. It was in a vessel with Yusha', upon him be peace, and it jumped out of the vessel towards the sea. Yusha' woke up and the fish fell into the water and started to swim through the water, leaving a track or channel behind it. Allah said: and it took its way through the sea as in a tunnel .} meaning, like going through a tunnel on land. Ibn Jurayj said, "Ibn 'Abbas said, It left a trace as if it were a rock."121 iSo when they had passed further on,} means, past the place where they had forgotten the fish. Forgetfulness is attributed to them both even though it was actually Yusha* who forgot. This is like the Ayah: jjjif Vi " iOut of them both come out pearl and coral.} [55:22], although they come from the salt water, according to one of the two opinions. When they had passed one stage beyond the place where they had forgotten the fish, 4ui JSi u'.bi &} i[Musd] said to his boy-servant: "Bring us our morning meal; m At-Tabari 18:57. [2' At-Tabari 18:57.

truly, we have suffered hi this, our journey meaning, their journey beyond the place where they should have stopped. 40,} 4Nasaban means, exhaustion. ^ j 0^1; •! ^ 4j. .ji tj tlyil sioJ Lj/l ij jli^> 4He said: "Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? I indeed forgot the fish ; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it..."} Then he said, took its course meaning its path, 4jjj,& £O jli :< Ce JC\ 4" ...into the sea in a strange (way)!" [Musa] said: "That is what we have been seeking."} meaning, this is what we have been looking for. 4^%} 4So they went back &} fiji Crl AliliC.J Oe i£ 4their footsteps.} 4Then they found one of Our servants, on whom We had bestowed mercy from Us, and whom We had taught knowledge from Us.} This was Al-Khidr, peace be upon him, as is indicated by the authentic Hadiths narrated from the Messenger of Allah jg. Al- Bukhari recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, "1 said to Ibn 'Abbas: 'Nawf Al-Bikali claims that Milsa, the companion of Al- Khidr was

not the Musa of the Children of Israel.' Ibn 'Abbas said, The enemy of Allah has told a lie.' Ubayy bin Ka*b narrated that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say,

‘^1 : y-Q I J;i : Ja2j Je'r!^ ij? kJ*3' >* '->! fJl «**1 i^Jl (*-M' jji jU ij jilt ill *J^ti £>>- :JU J v.lilS'3 4o U '-^y Jli . Ill d" j»J 0_^Ajl OJL«j Lw>»j tUlii U.i^-yj UJ>j iji..s>\ \ 121 Ijj <IU jy y £~y. »& J*4^1 ^ 'Ir* jAJl ^ .kili O ' jiSUJl ^ OjjiJl t Jai-L-l 12k i^Uajl 4-le- jLki ' .UJl Ayr <u)l .M.'-lij *. l2 '- jrf oil lil ,_> U x.:l.!j Lkfj^j J1L Uikili iOj>JL a^»J jl iU-Li ^_2 ^L_i lj!* L2jl JLS3 U»Ui lli)* : olil] Jli jJl «Mi7sfl gof up to deliver a speech before the Children of Israel and he was asked, “Wlw is the most learned person among the people?” Musa replied, "I am." Allah rebuked him because he did not refer the knowledge to Allah . So Allah revealed to him "At the junction of the tivo seas there is a servant of Ours who is more learned than you." Musa asked, "O my Lord, how can I meet him?" Allah said, "Take a fish and put it in a vessel and then set out, and where you lose the fish, you luill find him." So Musa took a fish, put it in a vessel and set out, along with his boy-servant Yiisha ‘ bin Nun, peace be upon him, till they reached a rock (on which) they both lay down their heads and slept. The fish moved vigorously in the vessel and got out of it and fell into the sea and there it took its tvay through the sea (straight) as in a tunnel. Allah stopped theflmo ofwater on both sides of the way created by the fish, and so that way was like a tunnel. When Musa got up, his companion forgot to tell him about the fish, and so they carried on their journey during the rest of the day and the whole night. The next morning Musa said to his boy-servant, i"Bring us our morning meal; truly, we have suffered much fatigue in this, ourjourney lolii A JU iAj <jll e^al (_gjil jLSsjJI jil>- ^>- jjj -ktfij li J I*j iitjLi ou Cjj\ :Jlii iLy a&j J 'kj — : Jli 4C# 4

jljg ig j Uc^i : Jli I^jW* >A3j(j [if li S^, ^ a • < ,»/ ^ ^ ^ S > a- j > ^ i / ^ ^ • , ^ 1j JUa ^j^y* 5r^ p-Lli iS^iwill JI : Jli <jui : Jli ^ j-y : Jlii lit :JUi .f**Ul Ju-jl u ^ J ai# ilij cJU U- i£it iul a£IIP <il jJU^ jJU cJj Jj ilia N oilp jill [*Jj? (*If *' ~ 7;iw Miisfl did not get tired till he had passed the place that Allah had ordered him to lookfor. His boy-servant then said to him, 4“Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? I indeed forgot the fish; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it. It took its course into the sea in a strange way.”4 There was a tunnel for the fish and Miisa and his boy-servant were amazed. Musa said, 4“That is what we have been seeking.” So they went back retracing theirfootsteps So they went back retracing their steps until they reached the rock. There they found a man covered with a garment. Musa greeted him. Al-Khidr said, "Is there such a greeting in your land?" Musa said, "I am Miisa." He said, "Are you the Musa of the Children of Israel?" Miisa said, "Yes," and added, "J have come to you so that you may teach me something of that bwledge which you have been taught." Al-Khidr said, 4"You will not be able to have patience with me .\$.» O Musa! I have some of Allah's knoivledge which He has bestoived upon me but you do not know it; and you too, have some of Allah's knowledge which He has bestowed upon you, but I do not knoiv it." :^r£L>J\ J Jli 4ir*' J (rCC ii* i_j“ J^ / * i ^ 0 S * * * ^ l ^ l • * I ^ ^ ^ • * yf V {_)jj l Iji k j l ^*_!L5n3 k O t >jJiiJL ^i^Jl fjA U-U ^JLs Ji Jlj SfJl?waj aLaJI ^a lls'j ilia

tL V JG ^ j jit 3 j>> \y\ viir jij Musa said, 4‘If Allah ivills, you will find me patient, and I will not disobey you in aught.”} Al-Khidr said to hint, 4“Then, if you folloio me, ask me not about anything till I myselfmention it to you.”} So they set out walking along the slwre, until a boat passed by and they asked the creiv to let them go on board. The crew recognized Al-Khidr and allowed them to go on

board free of charge. When they went on board, suddenly Musa saw that Al-Khidr had pulled out one of the planks of the ship with an adz. Musa said to him, "These people gave us a free ride, yet you have broken their boat so that its people will drown! Verily, you have done a terrible thing! 4"Al-Khidr said, "Did I not tell you, that you would not be able to have patience with me?" 4Musa said, "Call me not to account for what I forgot and be not hard upon me for my affair (with you)." The Messenger of Allah sg said, 'y- 3* gji jydal 'Vrj : Jli tCCJ ^-y 'j* I oltSo 3s: u? t : _rA»Jl <1 Jlii fi'y f °y> y-JJl ,J> ^ry- y jydo*3\ l-U ^aji, li Olj xijl -Lili ijuill iiJl 'j^aj\ jl J^LUL (fj> lip Xfj llii 'y JUi lilili oJu, iiSiSli 4j~'. i/i- *y J jil jii jsi jji jii 'In the first instance, Musa asked Al-Khidr because he had forgotten his promise. Then a bird came and sat on the edge of the boat, dipping its beak once or twice in the sea. Al-Khidr said to Musa, "My knowledge and your knowledge, in comparison to Allah's knowledge, is like what this bird has taken out of the sea." Then they both disembarked from the boat, and while they were walking on the shore, Al-Khidr saw a boy playing with other boys. Al-Khidr took hold of the boy's head and pulled it off with his hands, killing him. Musa said to him,

188 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4"Have you killed an innocent person who had killed none! Verily, you have committed a thing Nukr!" He said, "Did I not tell you that you would not be able to have patience with me?" } ly ja J UkAju .(Jl5 IjU-jA Ua^aZ^i* O' ij>lj U alC .J jo^ ^ii Utl 2sP" IaUwI ^ji <JLoS 4+^^*i} iJ-; JUi i ^ -kjj IjLU JU^0 *ffc. O-iiJ v-JL* UjiLa; jZJj Ujidaj (Ui 4-2* JJ & Jiiy^ [The narrator] said, "The second blame was stronger than the first one". 4Musa said, "If I ask you anything after this, keep me not in your company; you have received an excuse from me." Then they both proceeded until they came to the people of a town. They asked them for food but they refused to entertain them. (Then) they found there a wall on the point of falling down.} (Al-Khidr) set it up straight with his own hands. Musa said, "We came to these people, but they neither fed us nor received us as guests. 4If you had wished, surely, you could have taken wages for it!" (Al-Khidr) said: "This is the parting between you and I. I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were unable to be patient." } The Messenger of Allah Jg said: -y CU Jill JaZ Ji i ji Ujjj1 oWe wish that Musa was patient so that Allah would have told us more about both of them . Said bin Jubayr said: "Ibn 'Abbas used to recite [Ayah no. 79] (Cui* o«)LZ> jLiu- JS i>-t jJlZ jls'j) (There was a king before them who seized every good-conditioned ship by force) and [Ayah no 80] (^S)i Wf\ b'sj \j's ji& fviii liij)

(As for the boy, he was a disbeliever and his parents were believers.)¹¹¹ Then (in another narration) Al-Bukhari recorded a similar account which says: J)\ jy y £^y Jla gyj <-*^i JtJ ' £~»y :Jl» <• Uile- 'j'fj <j'e vjLiti ^> {ja i^wij V oUAJl by.^ roluij jvi I Uli JA<lj 4ir.*& " -then Musa set out and with him was his boy-servant Yusha bin Min, and they had the fish with them. When they reached the rock, they camped there, and Musa lay down his head and slept. At the base of the rock there was a spring called Al-Hdydt; its water never touched a thing but it brought it to life. Some of its water touched the fish, so it began to move and jumped out of the vessel and into the sea. When he woke up, Musa said to his boy-servant: iBring us our morning meal Then he quoted the rest of the Hadith. Then a bird came and perched on the edge of the ship, and dipped its beak in the sea, and Al-Khidr said to MQsa, "My knowledge and your knowledge and the knowledge of all I of creation, in comparison to the knowledge of Allah, is like what this bird has taken from the sea." Then he mentioned the rest of the report.*2 * T 466. Musa said to him: "May I follow you so that you teach me something of that knowledge which you have been taught (by Allah)?" } (I * Fath Al-Bari 8 :262 . 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :272 .

have knowledge from Allah that He has not taught you, and you have knowledge from Allah that He has not taught me. Each of us has responsibilities before Allah that the other does not share, and you will not be able to stay with me,' 4And how can you have patience about a thing which you know not?} 'For I know that you will denounce me justifiably, but I have knowledge of Allah's wisdom and the hidden interests which I can see but you cannot.' 4He said} meaning, Musa said: 41/ Allah wills, you will find me patient,} with whatever I see of your affairs, 4and I will not disobey you in aught.} means, 'I will not go against you in anything.' At that point, Al-Khidr, upon him be peace, set a condition: 4iis? o* oil 4Then, if you follow me, ask me not about anything} do not initiate any discussion of the matter, 4tiU I myself mention of it to you.} meaning, "until I initiate the discussion, before you ask me about it." <3b (ig&z i*^2 J cilj\$ jit ju 4:f:& 471- So they both proceeded, till, when they boarded the boat, he (Khidr) damaged it. Musa said: "Have you damaged it wherein its people will drown? Verily, you have committed a thing Imr."}

\$72. He said: "Did I not tell you, that you would not be able to have patience with me?" i73. He said: "Call me not to account for what I forgot, and be not hard upon me for my affair (with you)."} Damaging the Boat Allah tells us that Musa and his companion Al-Khidr set out having come to an agreement and reached an understanding. Al-Khidr had made the condition that Musa should not ask him about anything he found distasteful until he himself initiated the discussion and offered an explanation. So they went on board the ship, as described in the Hadith quoted above - the crew recognized Al-Khidr and let them ride on board free of charge, as an honor to Al-Khidr. When the boat took them out to sea and they were far from the shore, Al-Khidr got up and damaged the boat, pulling out one of its planks and then patching it up again. Musa, peace be upon him, could not restrain himself from denouncing him, so he said: iHave you damaged it wherein its people will drown? } The grammatical structure of the sentence in Arabic implies that this was the consequence, not the purpose, of his action. iVerily, you have committed a thing hnr,} About 'Imr', Mujahid said: "An evil thing. Qatadah said, "An astounding thing."121 At this point, reminding him of the previously-agreed condition, Al-Khidr said: d City jii iDid I not tell you, that you would not be able to have patience with me?} meaning, This thing that I did deliberately is one of the things I told you not to denounce me for, because you do not know At-Tabari 18:72. At-Tabari 18:72.

193Surah 18. Al-Kahf (74-76) (Part-16 the full story, and there is a reason and purpose for it that you do not know about.' 4He saidK meaning, Musa said: % C ciA# iCall me not to account for what I forgot, and be not hard upon me for my affair (with you).} meaning, 'do not be harsh with me.' Hence it says in the Hadith quoted above from the Messenger of Allah jg tr-J-* j-; «UCJ </« the first instance, Musa asked Al-Khidr because he had forgotten his promise .»' T" Jiilb -A*liS)» <JIs Lda Jil'j ^ 6 1JUC-IJLr-jS Lya^afl I JIS 6-d AlCvtSc'jl fy ^ i/ ^ i*' cifyjsl jjJ^li1(3>5j i-jLj 3 IS bs^csf <4^*43UHp La! LJj^UUaiU • 1^ cif jil j-ij iff) tlii ciii jli UUc CiJ Ij^ UiliS^ !Mi LsjJu «^1 C/- Jidfc. o', j6 -o jJ tilij oli Jii ji jli ^ y *,/;> '*; - •; - •: ». -> \ • V.^ • jo. ,y o*au -4 ^ 'k'.^i'. 474. Then they both proceeded till they met a boy, and he (Khidr) killed him. Musa said: "Have you killed an innocent person without Nafs? Verily, you have committed a thing Nukr/'> 475. He said: "Did I not tell you that you can have no [i] Fath Al-Bari8 :262

194 Tafsir Ibn Kathir patience with me?"} i76. He said: "If I ask you anything after this, keep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me."} The Story of killing the Boy 4Then they both proceeded,} means, after the first incident, UJ lij 4 till they met a boy, and he (Khidr) killed him.} It has been stated previously that this boy was playing with other boys in one of the towns, and that Al-Khidr deliberately singled him out. He was the finest and most handsome of them all, and Al-Khidr killed him. When Musa, peace be upon him, saw that he denounced him even more fervently than in the first case, and said hastily: 4 o-lii' iHavc you killed an innocent person?} meaning, a young person who had not yet committed any sin or done anything wrong, yet you killed him ^without Nafs} with no reason for killing him. 4(£i &£ SI* J%) 4 Verily, you have committed a thing Nukr!} meaning, something that is clearly evil. 4 v i*-* j -ifo, iii j»> jii jt»} 4He said: "Did I not tell you that you can have no patience with me?"} Once again, Al-Khidr reiterates the condition set in the first place, so Musa says to him: Of-i&b 0[] 4If I ask you anything after this,} meaning, 'if I object to anything else you do after this,'

Juj jj i yj® ikeep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me.} you have accepted my apology twice.' Ibn Jarir narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that Ubayy bin Ka*b said: "Whenever the Prophqt Sg mentioned anyone, he would pray for himself first. One day he said: : Jli •ilSL'j .. *—iuV 'f l^(J-j c.»l> OA j lijw aiilL-. the mercy of Allah be upon us and upon Musa. Ifhe had stayed with his companion he would have seen wonders, but he said, i'If 1 ask you anything after this, keep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me.'}"111 Oj b»Li I^Ia' 1 *ia!— ^ tx y > /_ / / « ' // / sibjJL- jij-uj (j'ji '-Ofc Jli vv J/>-' jui jJk*' U' ijl uilij'j jl Jli A*1 >Ia o' 4 vv L—^ O* Jr j L* Jojlit 477. Then they both proceeded till when they came to the people of a town, they asked them for food, but they refused to entertain them. Then they found therein a wall about to collapse and he set it up straight. (Musa) said: "If you had wished, surely you could have taken wages for it!"} i78. He said: "This is the parting between you and I, I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were not able to be patient."}

The Story of repairing the Wall

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3360–3365]

Allah tells us that 4u&u» ithey both proceeded} after the first two instances, iff} >t L? ~i| &}. At-Tabari 18:77.

4till when they came to the people of a town, ^ Ibn Jarir narrated from Ibn Sirin that this was Al-Aylah. According to the Hadith; • lillJ Z'ji Ijl uWhen they came there, the people of the town were mean.u^ i.e., miserly ^ tjj. jl Iflui lllliiJ.f^ ithey asked them for food, but they refused to entertain them. Then they found therein a wall about to collapse and he (Khidr) set it up straight.) means, he fixed it so it was standing upright properly. We have already seen in the Hadith quoted above that he set it up with his own hands, supporting it until it was standing straight again, which is something extraordinary. At this point Mtsa said to him: ilfyou had wished, surely you could have taken wages for it!) meaning, because they did not entertain us as guests, you should not have worked for them for free. 3!A '-ii iHe said: "This is the parting between you and I) meaning, because you said after the boy was killed that ifyou asked me anything after that, you would not accompany me any further. So this is the parting of the

ways between me and you. 41 will tell you the interpretation) meaning explanation, 4fjf* C) 4of (those) things over which you were not able to be patient.) At-Tabari 18:78. 121 Ahmad 5:119.

J Ju>u 4i f Jjj op ijil+ul jL^ \$ 4££; 479 “As for the boat, it te&y&&&0i£3>&2i£iz\$3i to poor people ,<i^V- -k’,^v , r V”1 ' c', working in the sea. So 1 U^l wished to make a defec- CJiU.ji tive dama8e in '*> “ iliJWj^ 'Cfae-I^JL^S them who seized every boat byforce.”) Interpretations of ^ged Ship liLJii£jjb^lidiSIUkJ;o&jL-\$-!j&<4jji This is an explanation ofwhat Musa found so * hard to understand, and the appearance of ^ ,0> . >*. V.-f-f ' which he condemned. @ Allah showed Al-Kljidr the hidden reasons, so he said, “1 damaged the ship to make it faulty, because theyused to pass byakinghowas one ofthe oppressors,who iU-\$ iseized every boat), i.e., every good, sound boat i&) iby force.) ‘So I wanted to prevent him from taking this boal; by making it appear faulty, so that its poor owners who had nothing else could benefit from it.’ It was also said that they were orphans. u4Sj£ <3 :£ ££=>; && J ti^ia tfjl 4#£ v^b ig *4& q;

£ Tafsir Ibn Kathtr 180. "And as for the boy, his parents were believers, and we feared he would oppress them by rebellion and disbelief."} 181 . "So we intended that their Lord should exchange him for them for one better in righteousness and nearer to mercy."} Interpretation ofwhy the Boy was killed Ibn ‘Abbas narrated from Ubayy bin Ka*b that the Prophet m said: “The boy Al-Khidr killed ivas destined to be a disbeliever from the day he was created.» It was recorded by Ibn Jarir from Ibn ‘Abbas.111 He said: ihis parents ivere believers, and we feared he tuould oppress them by rebellion and disbelief} Their love for him might make them follow him in disbelief. Qatadah said, “His parents rejoiced when he was born and grieved for him when he was killed. If he had stayed alive, he would have been the cause of their doom. So let a man be content with the decree of Allah, for the decree of Allah for the believer, if he dislikes it, is better for him than if He were to decree something that he likes for him.”*21 An authentic Hadith says; “Allah does not decree anything for the believer except it is goodfor />m.» And Allah says: iand it may be that you dislike a thing which is goodfor you.} (2:216). £ i4 £. oi Muslim 2380, At-Tabari 18:85. At-Tabari 18:86. 131 Ahmad 3:117.

4So we intended that their Lord should exchange him for them for one better in righteousness and nearer to mercy.} A child who was better than this one, a child for whom they would feel more compassion. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj. ^ tfjjUig0&& && 4 \$4.^ #4 aU'j jc- i C-_) d&j Ji LjO^ IaL, ') U Jjjii 482. “And as for the wall, it belonged to two orphan boys in\ the town ; and there was under it a treasure belonging to them ; and their father toas a righteous man, and your Lord intended that they should attain their age offull strength and take out their treasure as a mercy from your Lord. And' 1 did them notl of my own accord. That is the interpretation of those (things); over which you could not be patient.} Interpretation of why the Wall was repaired for no Charge In this Ayah there is a proof that the word Qaryah (village) may be used to refer to a city (Madinah), because Allah first says, 4if) >1 U &.) 4till when they came to the people of a toivn (Qaryah)} [18:77], but here He says: , 4 '&} 4it belonged to tioo orphan boys in the tenon (Al-Madinah) ;} This is like the Ayat. 4& ft *) of)} 4Atid many a town (Qan/ali), stronger than your toivn ivhic'i has driven you out We have destroyed} [47:13] and; 4 r ' (C-^ ft f 'Ti J>)) \$lij} 111 At-Tabari 18:86-87.

200 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4And they say: Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the tioo towns (Al-Qaryataxy ’>[43:3 1] meaning Makkah and At-Ta’if.

The meaning of Farwah here is a patch of withered vegetation.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3367–3368]

This was the view of ‘Abdur-Razzaq.*21 It was also said that it means the face of the earth. { { *To& ') C j-yi; 4That is the interpretation of those (things) over which you could not be patient.} meaning, ‘this is the explanation of the things which you could not put up with or be patient with until I took the initiative of explaining them to you.’ When he explained them and made them clear and solved the confusion, he used a milder form of the verb, {you could When the matter was still confusing and very difficult, a more intensive form was used, {&* t {I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were unable to be patient with} [18:78]. The intensity of the verbal form used reflects the intensity of the confusion felt. This is like the Ayah {So they (Ya’jiij and Ma’juj) were not able to scale it} [18:97] which means ascending to its highest point, {a ja Cj} {nor are they able to dig through it} [18:97] which is more difficult than the former. The intensity of the verbal form used reflects the difficulty of the action, which has to do with the subtleties of meaning. And Allah knows best. If one were to ask, what happened to the boy-servant of Musa who appears at the beginning of the story but then is not mentioned? The answer is that the objective of the story is Fath Al-Bari 6 :499 121 Ahmad 2:318.

Sfinih IS. Al-Kahf (83-84) (Part-Ib) 203 what happened between Musa and Al-Khidr. Musa’s boy servant was with him, following him. It is clearly mentioned in the Sahih Hadiths referred to above that he was Yusha‘ b n Nun, who was the one who became the leader of the Children of Israel after Musa, peace be upon him. ufjji j 4 SSA. \T J» (jAffSjA <_Si ,ji) 4 V • *jry •>! 483. And they ask you about Dhul-Qarnayn. Say: "/ shall recite to you something of his story."} 484. Verily, We established him in the earth, and We gave him the means of even/tling .}

The Story of Dhul-Qarnayn

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3368–3389]

Allah says to His Prophet jg, 4And they ask you} O Muhammad jg, (>) if} iabout Dhul-Qarnayn.} i.e., about his story. We have already mentioned how the disbelievers of Makkah sent word to the People of the Book and asked them for some information with which they could test the Prophet *g. They (the People of the Book) said, ‘Ask him about a man who traveled extensively throughout the earth, and about some young men who nobody knows what they did, and about the Ruh (the soul),’ then Surat Al-Kahf was revealed. Dhul-Qarnayn had great Power iufji’ 4 Jj it- iVerily, We established him in the earth,} means, “We have him great power, so that he had all that kings could have might, armies, war equipment and siege machinery.’ So he dominion over the east and the west, all countries and kings submitted to him, and all the nations, Arab and n Arab, served him. Some of them said he was called Dhul-Qarnayn (the one with two horns) because he reached the glVi tb en of lad eir on- ul- Uvo

2Q4 Tafsir Ibn Kathir “Homs” of the sun, east and west, where it rises and where it sets. 4^*- }^r£ Ji iand We gave him the means of everything.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and others said, “This means knowledge.”111 Qatadah also said, <c-&\$ iand We gave him the means of everything.} “The different parts and features of the earth.”121 Concerning

Bilqis, Allah said, A;J- y, ishe has been given all things [27:23], meaning all things that monarchs like her are given. Thus too was Dhul-Qamayn: Allah gave him the means of all things, meaning the means and power to conquer all areas, regions and countries, to defeat enemies, suppress the kings of the earth and humiliate the people of Shirk. He was given all that a man like him would need. And Allah knows best. l' " " . > **J . {if / ' 5- LJi " * m. Wv j0> /ijjj Jyj 'jOi & ft jii cJ o 1^*1 ot jj Jjii-j fj»r fd> !>•'. .it* tlj Uj* dj \$85. So he followed a way.} i86. Until, when he reached the setting place of the sun, he found it setting in a spring of Hami'ah. And he found near it a people. We said: "O Dhul-Qamayn! Either you punish them or treat them with kindness."} }87. He said: "As for him who does wrong, we shall punish him, and then he will be brought back unto his Lord, Who will punish him with a terrible torment (Hell)."} 111 Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah 2 : 106, At-Tabari 18 :94-95. 121 Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah 2 : 106, At-Tabari 18:94-95.

205 Surah 18. Al-Kahf (85-88) (Part-16) <(88. "But as for him who believes and works righteousness, he shall have the best reward, and we shall speak unto him mild words His traveling and reaching the Place where the Sun sets (the West) 4 So he followed a way .} Ibn 'Abbas said that he followed different routes to achieve what he wanted.' 4 So he followed a way.} Mujahid said that he followed different routes, east and west.' 2 ' According to one report narrated from Mujahid, said: he 4 a way} means, "A route through the land." 13 ' Qatadah said, ["It means he followed the routes and landmarks of the earth." 4 ' V_>* 1#* -^ 4 Until, when he reached the setting place of the sun,} means, he followed a route until he reached the furthest point that could be reached in the direction of the sun's setting, which is the west of the earth. As for the idea of his reaching the place in the sky where the sun sets, this is something impossible, and the tales told by storytellers that he traveled so far to the west that the sun set behind him are not true at all. Most of these stories come from the myths of the People of the Book and the fabrications and lies of their heretics. 4 he found it setting in a spring of Hami'ali At-Tabari 18:99. At-Tabari 18:95. At-Tabari 18:95. '4| At-Tabari 18:99.

206 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, he saw the sun as if it were setting in the ocean. This is something which everyone who goes to the coast can see: it looks as if the sun is setting into the sea but in fact it never leaves its path in which it is fixed. Hami'ah is, according to one of the two views, derived from the word Hama'ah, which means mud. This is like the Ayah: p- Si A£3&£& i "I am going to create a man (Adam) from dried clay of altered Hama'h (mud)} [15:28], which means smooth mud, as we have discussed above. li.ec i And he found near it a people.} meaning a nation. They mentioned that they were a great nation from among the sons of Adam. 4 ^-* - (*ti o' fy i)' 'JO i We (Allah) said (by inspiration): "O Dhul-Qamayn! Either you punish them or treat them with kindness"} means, Allah gave him power over them and gave him the choice: if he wanted to, he could kill the men and take the women and children captive, or if he wanted to, he could set them free, with or without a ransom. His justice and faith became apparent in the ruling he pronounced: 4 As for him who does wrong, meaning who persists in his Kufr and in associating others in worship with his Lord, i we shall punish him,} Qatadah said, i.e., by killing him. % '£} i and then he i will be brought back unto his Lord, Wlw will punish him with a terrible torment.} meaning a severe, far-reaching and painful punishment. This m At-Tabari 18:98.

Sfirah 18. Al-Kahf (89-91) (Part-16 ^ mmi r-r - -i' i,." . > saaiii llu- lll- ^fo* <4 ' / {/ {^/ ^ ^ #> {-/ <<,<•>< / / />> /> J^wj jc_j«Jla3jlU^vyuMJCjUSL«jiU»J^X^JJ " •:•'< 4t. "rl u-iftfftrf^ * «*.\$££&? ifr'i&j\$\$\$£&£&£'&> &\$ £^51^- i/i" l«JUa*~ja_>dUljo^^La— 4^jaL«— j^A^t^4ll'i>jgUL?a»-^pL^ £j»- ly u]0}L/^ ' \JkliLjJ^Vp*^yQj^aijOJ-i^V Jj-> ./ •*, ^V* *£ #>. 'J.^ y.^ *» yy *' ' |y- A— <Jl5 implies a confirmation of the Hereafter and the reward an|< punishment. i*c z 0;> 4B«! as /or /iim tojio believes), meaning “who follows us in our call to worship Allah Alone with no partnjer or associate,’ &&& 4he shall Iwve the best reward, meaning in the Hereafter, wijth Allah. AiA w *A ^y--j) iand we (DHul-Qarnayn) shall speak unto him mild words.) Mujahid said, ‘(words of) kindness. 11 ' oi s-A S*y 'A fy & ^ 'j) i*»- ,A>.Lk— iip&& Cl<& 5J 4>r :f/L 4S9. Then /ie folloived (another) way,) 490. Until, when he came to the rising place of the sun, he found it rising on a people for whom We (Allah) had provided no shelter against the sun.) 491 . So (it was)! And We knew all about him (Dhul- Qamayn).) At-Tabari 18:99.

Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr 208 His Journey East Allah tells us that Dhul-Qarnayn then traveled from the west of the earth towards the east. Every time he passed a nation, he subjugated the people and called them to Allah. If they obeyed him, all well and good, otherwise he would humiliate them and take their wealth and possessions. From every nation he took what his armies needed to fight the next nation. When he reached the place where the sun rises, as Allah says, &£j} ihfound it rising on a people meaning a nation, Wijj >4* ££ 3} ifor whom We (Allah) had provided no shelter against the sun.} meaning, they had no buildings or trees to cover them and shade them from the heat of the sun. Qatadah said, “It was mentioned to us that they were in a land where nothing grew, so when the sun rose they would go into tunnels until it had passed its zenith, then they would come out to go about their daily lives and earn themselves a living.”111 ii *3 Ct t&J£ iSo (it was)! And Webmv all about him.} Mujahid and As-Suddi said, ‘This means that Allah knew everything about him and his army, and nothing was hidden from Him, even though they came from so many different nations and lands. For, ? a vj 4 *> iTruly, nothing is hidden from Allah, in the earth or in the heaven,}{3:5}”^ V bji I * . y1 -Wj ju ^ ^ v u_ /} At-Tabari 18:100. At-Tabari 18:101.

G, jlif o' U)»- ill! J-jf jv ^ jj-u-i- gjXi) 0 »-C O' kjfcjjtf' '->4 jjjJJ jj> loj pr'fj j*y •>“ _£»-^ U JIS 'y',0u. 4 , —li3 Jli ij-j jk^a- 'i) Jti cJji 'j) ^y>- 492. Then hefollowed (another) way,} 493. Until, ivhen he reached betxveen two mountains, hefound before them a people who scarcely understood a word 494. They said: "O Dhul-Qamayn! Verily, Ya'juj and Ma'juj are doing great mischief in the land. Shall we then pay you a tribute in order that you might erect a barrier between us and them?"} He said: "That in which my Lord had established me is better. So help me with strength, I will erect betxveen you and them a barrier."} "Give me Zubar of iron;" then, when he had filled up the gap betxveen the two mountain-cliffs, he said: "Bloxy;" then when he had made them (red as) fire, he said: "Bring me Qitran to pour over them."} His Journey to the Land of Ya'juj and Ma'juj, and building the Barrier Allah says of Dhul-Qamayn: £\ ?} iThen he folloived (another) xoay} meaning, he traveled from the east of the earth until he reached a place between the two mountains which were next to one another with a valley in between, from which Ya'juj and Ma'juj (God and Magog) will emerge into the land of the Turks and spread mischief there, destroying crops and people. Ya'jQj and Ma'juj are among he progeny of Adam, peace be upon him, as was recorded in :he Two Sahlhs; k^01 : JjXj : J U : iul o|& _>01 i*p : J ?j0l <^Ju Uj jl . dlīi . kl^IS k ^Jl -X>- gyrh tip Y* jt ^ Jp\

mn iv ^ Similarly, Dhul-Qarnayn said: "What I have is better than what you want to give me, but help me with strength," i.e., with your labor and construction equipment, 4/ u;i// crecf between you and them a barrier. Give me Zubar of iron,} Zubar is the plural of Zubrah, which means pieces or chunks of something. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah.¹¹¹ These pieces were like bricks or blocks, and it was said that each block weighed one Damascene QintajJ21 or 4 Of. isjc. *jj ig*-} 4then, when he had filled up the gap between the tioo mountain-cliffs,} means, he put the blocks on top of one another, starting at the bottom, until he reached the tops of the mountains, fili ng the width and height of the gap. The scholars differed about the precise width and height. 4he said: "Blozv;"} means, he lit a fire until the whole thing was burning hot. 4he said: "Bring me Qitran to pour over them."} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and As- Suddi said it was copper. Some of them added that it was molten.¹³¹ This is similar to the Ayah: & £ <Zj} 4And We caused afount ofQitran toflowfor him} [34:12]. So it resembled a striped cloak. 111 At-Jabari 18:114. . 121 Qintdr; a unit of weight equivalent to 256.4 kg. (Hans Vfehr Dictionary of Modern Written Arabic) . See the explanation of SQrah Al 'Imran 3 :14 . j [3! At-Jabari 18:116-117, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :460

212 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Then Allah said: Jj -Xy ilf liji irt U» Jli Jd J J IpLilt ^0 4/ . ** •" . > >- , /•' j/*' \ZiC' a"-*A+ »/ ^ p4 ,»* Jr-" J fJ oj" f 4 J-y; »J>_> ,Vk,U». jj j*, jly iB3 /Uf 4&3ti£ 497. So they could not scale it or dig through it.} 498. He said: "This is a mercy from my Lord, but wlten the promise of my Lord comes, He shall Dakka' it down to the ground. And the promise ofmy Lord is ever true.} 499. And on that Day, We shall leave some of them to surge like waves on one another; and the Trumpet will be blown, and We shall collect them (the creatures) all together.} The BarrierrestrainsThem,but It willbebreachedwhen the Hour draws nigh Allah tells us that Ya'juj and Ma'juj could not climb over the barrier or penetrate its lower portion. Varying forms of the verb are used here in the Arabic text to reflect the difficulty of the action referred to. 4(|:<2 % i j a} iSo they (Ya'juj and Ma'juj) could not scale it or dig through it.} This indicates that they could not penetrate it or dig through it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Zaynab bint Jahsh, the wife of the Prophet jg said, "The Prophet woke from sleep, and he was red in the face. He said, fij j* s* Iri 'r'jty Jij i.') Y" «iJu jL «La ilaha illallah! Woe to the Arabs from the evil that has approached (them) . Today a hole has been opened in the barrier of Ya'juj and Ma'juj like this .» and he made a circle with his index finger and thumb. I (Zaynab) said, 'O Messenger of Allah, will we be destroyed even though there will be righteous people among us?' He said:

p iSj "Yes, if evil increases .n" ' This is a Sahlh Hadith, both A- Bukhari and Muslim recorded it. 44>« '**> 36^ i(Dhul-Qamayn) said: "This is a mercyfrom my Lord..."} meaning, after it was built by Dhul-Qamayn. 4<4> A iHe said: This is a mercyfrom my Lord} for the people, when he placed a barrier between them and Ya'juj and Ma'juj, to stop them from spreading evil and corruption on earth. ^jj J6J 'U liji^ ibut when the promise of my Lord comes} means, when the true promise comes iHe shall Dakka' it down to the ground.} means, will make it flat. The Arabs use Dakka ' to describe a female camel whose back is flat and has no hump. And Allah says: i\ks>'> fij Pr&} 4So when his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it Dakka >i} [7:143] meaning, level to the ground. 4lii (f> m.j '\$>} iAnd the promise ofmy Lord is ever true.} means, it will come to pass without a doubt. 4We shall leave some of them} meaning mankind, on that day, the day when the barrier will be breached and these

people (Yajuj and Ma'juij) will come out surging over mankind to destroy their wealth and property. 4 (Vi j-fJ. ^j->) ^ Ahmad 6:428. 121 Path Al-Bari 6 :440 , Muslim 4 :2208

214 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iWe shall leave some of them to surge like waves on one another;} As-Suddi said: "That is when they emerge upon the people." All of this will happen before the Day of Resurrection and after the Dajjal, as we will explain when discussing the Ayat. iUntil, when Ya'juj and Ma'juj are let loose, and they swoop down from every Hadab. And the true promise shall draw near.. } [21:96-97] iand As-Sur will be blown. }As-Sur, as explained in the Hadith, is a horn that is blown into. The one who will blow into it is (the angel) Israfil, peace be upon him, as has been explained in the Hadith quoted at length above, and there are many Hadiths on this topic.*2 * According to a Hadith narrated from 'Atiyah from Ibn 'Abbas*3 * and Abu Said, and attributed to the Prophet uHow can I relax when the one with the Horn has put the Horn in his mouth and has knelt down, listening out for the command to be given to him?» They said, "What should we say?" He said: «il JU jLJ 4)1 «Say : "Allah is Sufficient for us and the best Disposer of affairs, in Allah have we put our trust .»*4 iand We shall collect them (the creatures) all together.} means, *We shall bring them all together for Reckoning. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur4 :454 TuhfatAl-Ahwardhi 9 :1 16. At-Tabari 18:122. ' Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 7:117.

r«t m% ,/ >.//// "?y + S ~S S' - ' \m jSS| '\$\$& zj&q ; > '%C?'A'.'s. ' >-^•-*;' i-IT^1 , 'ji'ty'i&J2-W) ^Uil ^"J, » \l .1 ji^r*.J Vlj\l^l _0 S(J^' 1J . -!« .JLIJ.11^ #Sw4i'j i£»V' S| 4^(0& (V. 'h', d(i>£r*Si 4Say : "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of late j- times. All will surely be gathered together for ap pointed meeting of knownDay.} (56:49-50 •>• • ,2 :{. •>;<" u l*r« Ji1" {*• (H-i/'-*-J7 4®'j4' 4«n</ we s/w// gather them all together so as o /eaeue not one of then behind.} [18:47] UgrQ H'S. f*? &V-S 4 \$\$ ar y> ijy»..L^_> V l_pl\$ c^jii juje o' £ir y? c~^ -^cp C[*Cl>' s)->J <Jt b-W; '4^5 ^100. And on that Day We s/irt// presetit Hell to the disbelievers, plain to view.} 4101. (To) those whose eyes had been under a covering from My Reminder, and they could not bear to hear (it).} 4102. Do then those who disbelieved think that they can take My servants as Awliya [protectors] besides Me? Verily, We have prepared Hell as an entertainmentfor the disbelievers.} Hell willbe displayedbefore the Disbelieverson theDay ofResurrection Allah tells us what He will do to the disbelievers on the Day of Resurrection. He will show Hell to them, meaning He will bring it forth for them to see its punishment and torment before

they enter it. This will intensify their distress and grief. In Sahih Muslim it is recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah said, (>Uj js y. i^Uj Ji\ yf, j'y.' "Hell will be brought forth on the Day of Resurrection, pulled by means of seventy thousand reins, each of which will be held by seventy thousand angels ,»m Then Allah says of them: 4(To) those whose eyes had been under a covering from My Reminder,} meaning, they neglected it, turning a blind eye and a deaf ear to it, refusing to accept guidance and follow the truth. As Allah says: W J** A & o-*i o*j7 4And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious, We appoint for him a Shaytdn to be a companion for him. [43:36] And here Allah says: jji-tLj V \$s%j} iand they could not bear to hear (it).} meaning, they did not understand the commands and prohibitions of Allah. Then He says: 4Do then those who disbelieved think that they can take My servants as Aiuliya' [protectors] besides Me?} meaning, do they think that this is right for them and that it is going to benefit them? ppk&& (*r>^ \$£&r- 4Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them} [19:82], IU Muslim 4 :2184.

Allah says that He has prepared Hell as their abode on the Day of Resurrection. [r^ O'j]* Vy^ j frf- '& pf ji M! (*4^ |i^jj ^4^ Julji ;W^liLi £j)&£M !\$''' ^ rg/iS 4103. Sax/: "Shall I've tell you the greatest losers in respect of (their) deeds?" } 4104. "Those whose efforts have been wasted in this life while they thought that they were acquiring good by their deeds." } 4105. "They are those who deny the Ayat of their Lord and the meeting with Him. So their works are in vain, and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them." } 4106. "That shall be their recompense, Hell; because they disbelieved and took My Ayat and My Messengers for jest." } The Greatest Losers in respect of (Their) Deeds Al-Bukhari recorded from 'Amr that Mus'ab who said: "I asked my father - meaning Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas - about Allah's saying, V&v p? > 4 Say "Shall We tell you the greatest losers in respect of (their) deeds?" } I 'Are they the Haruriyyah?' He said, 'No, they are the Jews and Christians. As for the Jews, they disbelieved in Muhammad 535, and as for the Christians, they disbelieved in Paradise and said that there is no food or drink there, and the Haruriyyah are those who break Allah's covenant after ratifying it.' Sa'd (L used to call them Al-Fasiqin (the corrupt). 'Ali bin Abi Talib, 121 Ad-Dahhak and others said: "They are the Haruriyyah," so this means, that according to 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, this Ayah includes the Haruriyyah just as it includes the Jews, the Christians and others. This does not mean that the Ayah was revealed concerning any of the Fath Al-Bari 8:278. At-Tabari 18:128.

218 Tafslr Ibn Kathir groups in particular; it is more general than that, because the Ayah was revealed in Makkah, before the Qur'an addressed the Jews and Christians, and before the Khawarij existed at all. So the Ayah is general and refers to everyone who worships Allah in a way that is not acceptable, thinking that he is right in doing that and that his deeds will be accepted, but he is mistaken and his deeds will be rejected, as Allah says: iSome faces, that Day will be humiliated. Laboring, weary. They will enter in the hot blazing Fire.} [88:2-4] iAnd We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} [25:23] 'jj tel ' A.;!*- iAs for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing [24:39] And in this Ayah Allah says: iSay: "Shall We tell you..." } meaning, Shall We inform you; 'the greatest losers in respect of (their) deeds?' } Then Allah explains who they are, and says: 4Those whose efforts have been wasted in this life } meaning, they did deeds that do not count, deeds that are not in accordance with the prescribed way that is acceptable to Allah. pr* 'ifr iwhile they thought that they were acquiring good by their deeds.}

means, they thought that there was some basis for their deeds and that they were accepted and loved. iThey are those who deny the Ayat of their Lord and the meeting with Him.} they denied the signs of Allah in this world, the proofs that He has established of His Oneness and of the truth of His Messengers, and they denied the Hereafter. iiii pp iand on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them.' } means, *We will not make their Balance heavy because it is empty of any goodness.' Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said: : jii; - ^ <i x* v ugi^ Jq jj " «A huge fat man will come forward on the Day of Resurrection and he will weigh no more than the wing of a gnat to Allah. Recite, if you wish :» iand on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them It was also recorded by Muslim.[1! C -ff/r l&i} iThat shall be their recompense, Hell; because they disbelieved means, *We will punish them with that because of their disbelief and because they took the signs and Messengers of Allah as a joke, mocking them and disbelieving them in the worst

way.' il07. "Verily, those who believe and do righteous deeds, shall Fath At-Bari 8 -.279 , Muslim 4 : 2147

1) 4No desire will they have for removal therefrom. means, they will never choose or want anything else. Th: Ayah tells us how much they love and desire it, even though one might imagine that a person who is to stay in one place forever would get tired and bored of it. But Allah tells us that despite this eternal stay, they will never choose to change <j>r move from where they are. jib jj Jj xxi op o'JfCi _}) 41\$<z 4109. Say: "If the sea were ink for the Words of my Lord, surely, the sea would be exhausted before the Words of my Lord would be finished, even if We brought like it far its aid.") The Words of the Lord can never be finished Allah says: 'Say, O Muhammad, if the water of the sea were ink for a pen to write down the words, wisdom and signs of Allah, the sea would run dry before it all could be written down. jb> 4even if We brought like it) means, another sea, then another, and so on, additional seas to be used for writing. The Words (of Allah would still never run out. As Allah says: o'4 u +% %\ « j)i\ 4a ^) ii' 4And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea (were ink), with seven seas behind it to increase it, yet the Words of Allah would not be exhausted. Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.) [31:271 Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said, "The parable of the knowledge of all of mankind, in comparison to the knowledge of Allah, is that a drop of water in comparison to all of the oceans." Allah revealed that: 4^j ^£4 jiw J Ji op jQ if* \$

i5& ty} iis One God}, with no partner or associate.' iSo whoever hopes for the meeting with his Lord,} i.e., hopes for good reward and recompense, i let him work righteousness} meaning, in accordance with the prescribed laws of Allah, 4SS5 fj 4/j fj} i and associate none as a partner in the worship of his Lord.} This is what is meant by seeking the pleasure of Allah alone with no associate or partner. These are the two basic features of acceptable deeds: their intent is for the sake of Allah alone, and are done in accordance with the way of the Messenger of Allah jg . Imam Ahmad recorded that Mahmud bin Labld said that the Messenger of Allah sg said: l h'jh' 'Jdi. Ju-i U Sj "What I fear the most for you is the small Shirk. "They said: What is the small Shirk, O Messenger of Allah?" He said, i Jjrr»* lij i*Ui)l ("ji *U1 1 Jbj j % » D ^*-l^" j v Ujjjl ^ "Showing off (Ar-Riya). Allah toil! say on the Day of Resurrection , when the people are rewarded or punished for their deeds, "Go to the one for whom you were showing off in the world and see if you will find any reward with /j/hj." Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said bin Abi Fadal Al- Ansari, who was one of the Companions, said: "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, m Ahmad 5 :428

Jb {jA . jU* tfZb 4-3 UJJ y Aa\ ,^•1 4)1 0^5 '4)1 jl*' 4^ i!rf \$j> iil>lj| j. t\Z'Jj\ ^Allah will gather the first and the last on the Day of Resurrection, the Day concerning which there is no doubt. A voice will call out, "Whoever used to associate anyone with Allah in the deeds which he did, let him seek his reward from someone other than Allah, for Allah is the least in need of any partner or associate It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah.12' This is the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Kahf. Praise be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.

Surah 19: Maryam

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3390–3434]

Opening The Tafslr of Surah Maryam (Chapter - 19) Which was revealed in Makkah Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded a Hadith of Umm Salamah 1 ' 1 in his Sirah, and Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded from Ibn Mas'ad, the story of the Hijrah (migration) to Ethiopia from Makkah. The narration mentions that Ja'far bin Abi Talib recited the first part of this Surah to An-Najashi and his companions. 12 ' In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 36 iT .tSii. iijj gj txS Oilj Jii ; vly |>f==3 pj jjfy\ JjC-Ljj jtiiij' •i " * *. 'l/ | ^ / . ')j I > ./ . < * . < > “'x^ /V , » **^®«*» Ot <Jf y-Z'c Ctlr*' £*\frs»j iSvjJ ot 4 ' yj •aJ-iar'j V>tiu JI» ^ 41 • KdfHa Ya 'Am Sad.} 42. A reminder of the mercy of your Lord to His servant Zakariyya 43. When he called his Lord [with] a call in secret.} 44. He said: "My Lord! Indeed my bones have grown feeble, and gray hair has Ashta'al on my head, and I have never been unblessed in my invocation to You, O my Lord!"} 45. "And verily, I fear Mawali after me, and my wife is barren. So give me from Yourself an heir."} 46. "Who shall inherit me, and inherit (also) the posterity of Ya'qub. And make him, my Lord, one with whom You are well-pleased!"} 111 Ibn Hisham 1 :357. 121 Ahmad 1 :201 ,461

The Story of Zakariyya and His Supplication for a Son The discussion about the separate letters has already preceded at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. Concerning Allah's statement, %} iA reminder of the mercy of your Lord^ This means that this is a reminder of Allah's mercy upon His servant Zakariyya . 111 Yahya bin Ya'mar recited it, o.JLP “He has reminded of your Lord's mercy to His servant Zakariyya.” The word Zakariyya in the Ayah has been recited with elongation and also shortened. Both recitations are well-known. He was a great Prophet from the Prophets of the Children of Israel. In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is recorded [that the Prophet sg said about Zakariyya] that He was a carpenter who used to eat from what he earned with his own hand through carpentry . Concerning Allah's statement, iWlwn he called his Lord [with] a call in secret.} He only made his supplication secretly because it is more beloved to Allah. This is similar to what Qatadah said concerning this Ayah, ^ .Cj . ^When he called out his Lord [with] a call in secret.} “Verily, Allah knows the pious heart and he hears the hidden voice.”131 4l 4*-> 4He said: "My Lord! Indeed my bones have grown feeble..."} m Al-Qurtubi 11 :75. Muslim 4 : 1847. We were unable to locate it with Al-Bukhari. At-Tabari 18:142.

meaning, “I have become weak and feeble in strength.” iand gray hair has Ashta'al oti my head,} means the gray hair has turned into the black hair. The intent is to inform of weakness and old age, and its external and internal traces. Concerning Allah's statement, iand I have never been unblessed in my invocation to You, O my Lord!^ This means, “I have not experienced from You except that You would respond to my supplication and that You would never refuse me in whatever I ask of You.” Concerning

His statement, *And verily, I fear Mawali after me*,} Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi, all said, “In saying the word Mawali, he (Zakariyya) meant his succeeding relatives.”

The reason for his fear was that he was afraid that the generation that would succeed him would be a wicked generation. Thus, he asked Allah for a son who would be a Prophet after him, who would guide them with his prophethood and that which was revealed to him. In response to this I would like to point out that he was not afraid of them inheriting his wealth. For a Prophet is too great in status, and too lofty in esteem to become remorseful over his wealth in this fashion. A Prophet would not disdain to leave his wealth to his successive relatives, and thus ask to have a son who would receive his inheritance instead of them. This is one angle of argument. The second argument is that Allah did not mention that *lie* (Zakariyya) was wealthy. On the contrary, he was a carpenter who ate from the earnings of his own hand. This type of person usually does not have a mass of wealth. Amassing At-Tabari 18:144.

228 Tafslr Ibn Kathir wealth is not something normal for Prophets, for verily, they are the most abstentious in matters of this worldly life. The third argument is that it is confirmed in the Two Sahihs, in more than one narration, that the Messenger of Allah said, *USjj La i kIjjj jI® iWe* (the Prophets) do not leave behind inheritance (of wealth). Whatever we leave behind, then it is charity. In a narration recorded by At-Tirmidhi with an authentic chain of narrations, he said, *f .dVi jJJS* “We, Prophets do not leave behind inheritance (of wealth) .»*21 Therefore, the meaning in these Hadiths restricts the meaning of Zakariyya’s statement, *4So give me from yourself an heir. Who shall inherit me,*} inheritance of prophethood. For this reason Allah said, *J'» Cft iand inherit* (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} This is similar to Allah’s statement, *4And Sulayman inherited from Daioud.*}[27:16] This means that he inherited prophethood from him. If this had meant wealth, he would not have been singled with it among his other brothers. There also would have been no important benefit in mentioning it if it was referring to wealth. It is already well-known and established in all of the previous laws and divinely revealed creeds, that the son inherits the wealth of his father. Therefore, if this was not referring to a specific type of inheritance, then Allah would not have mentioned it. All of this is supported and affirmed by what is 111 Fath Al-Bari 6 :227, Muslim 3 :1383 2] Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 5 :234

229 Surah 19. Manmm (7) (Part-16) in the authentic Hadlth: *dWc* Prophets do not leave behind any inheritance (of wealth). Whatever we leave behind, then it is charity. [1 ' Mujahid said concerning his statement, *J' iWho shall inherit me, and inherit* (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} [19:6] “His inheritance was knowledge, and Zakariyya was one of the descendants of Ya'qub. 121 " Hushaym said, “Ismail bin Abi Khalid informed us that Abu Salih commented about the Ayah: *iwho shall inherit me, and inherit* (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} “He would be a Prophet like his forefathers were Prophets.”13 Allah’s statement, *iU iand make him, my Lord, one with whom You are well- pleased!*} means “Make him pleasing to You (Allah) and your creation. Love him and make him beloved to your creatures, in both his religion and his character.” *Jt* Oi 1*1 fgf-. Art 47.* (Allah said:) “O Zakariyya! Verily, We give you the good news of a son, whose name will be Yahyd. We have given that name to none before (him).”} Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 5 :234 |2! At-Jabari 18:146. At-Tabari 18:146.

r. Jj 3 Tfl/sfr lbtI Kathir r*e USt 31 CpC^sy i o-a*?4- 0i^V4^A clt>>J«Uc pJJ 'S^~^~^JL^l Cp xljJJ 4V-4^ LI*^» dJJS^JIS0 5J^l>s v*~^ 'o^l. The acceptance of His Supplication This statement implies what is not mentioned, that his supplication was answered. It was said to him, A 2\$ ^ W*> 4(Alldh

said:) "O Zakariyya! Verily, We give you the glad tidings of a son, whose name will be Yahyd...">
 Similarly Allah, the Exalted, said; , / ' |i/ * /• X / ^ f V ^->j Ji ajj ISj.'hsAj Uj i'*L iut <iA . •" <—l> AJJJ
 ~_iA*JU IjA J T*, *I£jjl "i.^ j ^3 £ is^uf ^*1-. ji *— 'J--'J «if w sii £ tiJj <Af that time Zakariyya
 invoked his Lord, saying: "O my Lord! Grant me from Yoti, a good offspring. You are indeed the All-
 Hearer of invocation ." Then the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the MihrdbJ11
 (saying): "Allah, gives you glad tidings of Yahyd, confirming (believing in) the word from Allah, noble,
 keeping away from sexual relations with women, a Prophet, from among the righteous.">[3:38-39]
 Allah said, in a private place of worship

iWe have given that name to none before (him).} Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Zayd said, "This means
 that no one had this name before him." 1 11 Ibn Jarir preferred this interpretation, may Allah have
 mercy upon him. ck o-dj v-*2==y 4 4^ ji i; # oj iE ju v;cL£ 48. He said: "My Lord! How can I have a
 son, when my wife is barren, and I have reached the extreme old age."} 49. He said: "Thus your Lord
 says: 'It is easy for Me. Certainly I have created you before, when you had been nothing!'" >[19:8-9]
 His amazement after the acceptance of his Supplication Zakariyya was amazed when his supplication was
 answered and he was given the good news of a son. He became extremely overjoyed and asked how
 this child would be born to him, and in what manner he would come. This was particularly amazing
 because his wife was an old woman who was barren and had not given birth to any children in her
 entire life. Even Zakariyya himself had become old and advanced in years, his bones had become
 feeble and thin, g^nd he had no potent semen or vigor for sexual intercourse. The Answer of the Angel
 4He said :? That is, the angel, in his response to Zakariyya and his Was amazement. 4 ci* jb ^ 4"Thus
 says your Lord : 'It is easy for Me...' " } (i| At-Tabari 18:148.

Meaning the birth of the son will be from you and from this wife of yours and not from any other
 (woman). ieasy Meaning, it is simple and easy for Allah to do. Then he (the angel) mentioned to him
 that which is more amazing than what he was asking about. The angel said that the Lord said, iCertainly
 I have created you before, when you had been nothing!} This is similar to Allah's statement, 4 i Up. ^3
 p jLj]f j: oj-. jt ojl iHas there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth
 mentioning?} [76:1) j\$3 jte isi; 4 £ ti} ^20. He [Zakariyyd] said: "My Lord! Appoint for me a sign." He
 said: "Your sign is that you shall not speak unto mankind for three nights, though having no bodily
 defect."} ill. Then he came out to his people from the Mihrab and he indicated to them by signs to
 glorify [Allah] in the morning and in the afternoon.} The Sign of the Pregnancy Allah, the Exalted,
 informed about Zakariyya that he said, tj 'j'j iHe (Zakariyyd) said: "My Lord! Appoint for me a sign."}
 "Give me a sign and a proof of the existence of that which You have promised me, so that my soul will
 be at rest and my heart will be at ease with Your promise. "Similarly Ibrahim said, i&j d? Oijr j>y JI* aj-
 fi ifj •-ff} iMy Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead. He (Allah)

233 Surah 19. Maryam (10-11) (Part-16) said: "Do you not believe?" He said: "Yes (I believe), but to
 put my heart at ease." ^[2:260] Then Allah says, i&X jlft 4He said: "Your sign is..."> meaning, "Your
 sign will be..." 4that you shall not speak unto mankind for three nights, though having no bodily defect.
 Meaning, 'your tongue will be prevented from speaking for three nights while you are healthy and fit,
 without any sickness or illness.' Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Wahb, As- Suddi, Qatadah and others
 said, "His tongue was arrested without any sickness or illness." 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam

said, "He used to recite and glorify Allah, but was not able to speak to his people except by gestures. 'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4three nights, though having no bodily defect. "The nights were consecutive." However, the first statement that is reported from him and the majority is more correct. This Ayah is similar to what Allah, the Exalted, said in Sut^{ah} Al 'Imran, he £- . 'Ljj 4He said: "O my Lord! Make a sign for me." (Allah) said[^] "Your sign is that you shall not speak to mankind for three days except with signals. And remember your Lord much, and glorify (Him) in the afternoon and in the morning.[^][3:41] This is a proof that he did not speak to his people for these three nights and their days as well. 111 At-Tabari 18:152. At-Tabari 18:152.

iexcept with signals.) Meaning, with bodily gestures, this is why Allah says in this noble Ayah, S; & gk) iThen he came out to his peoplefrom the Mihrdb) referring to the place where he was given the good news of the child. 4't§ ihe indicated to them by signs Meaning he made a gesture to them that was subtle and swift. ito glorify [Allah] in the morning and in the afternoon.) That they should be agreeable to what he was commanded to do during these three days, to increase in his deeds and gratitude to Allah for what He had given him. Mujahid said,)he indicated to them by signs) "He made a gesture."* 11 Wahb and Qatadah said the same. 121 fyj Aj fji *2* (A-J . bU*- i-ri 412. (ft was said to his son) : "O Yahya! Hold fast to the Scripture." And We gave him wisdom while yet a child.) 413. And Hanananfrom Us, and Zakatan, and he was pious,) 414. And dutiful to his parents, and he was not arrogant or disobedient.) 415. And Salam (peace) be on him the day he was bom, and the day he dies, and the day he will be raised up to life (again!) At-Jabari 18:153. At-Tabari 18:154.

The Birth ofthe Boy and His Characteristics This also implies what is not mentioned, that this promised boy was bom and he was Yahya. There is also the implication that Allah taught him the Book, the Tawrah which they used to study among themselves. The Prophets who were sent to the Jews used to rule according to the Tawrah, as did the scholars and rabbis among them. He was still young in ege when Allah gave him this knowledge. This is the reason that Allah mentioned it. parents, He says, Because of how Allah favored him and his de, asWi 4.)jh s[^]4=«J' £ 40 Yahya! Holdfast to the Scripture [the Tawrah].} Means, "Learn the Book with strength." In other words, le[^]rn it well, with zeal and studious effort. 4[^] jgii 4And We gave him ivisdom while yet a child.} This means he was given understanding, knowledge, fortitu diligence and zeal for good and the pursuit of good. He blessed with these characteristics even though he was young Allah said, 4& ji 4And (made him) Hanananfrom Us,} [19:13] Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, c/j 6&-j} 4And Hanananfrom Us,} "This means mercy from Us." 'Ikrimah, Qatadah and |Ad- Dahhak all said the same. Ad-Dahhak added, "Mercy that; no one would be able to give except Us." Qatadah added, "With it, Allah had mercy upon Zakanyya."*21 Mujahid said, hi At-Tabari 18:156. 121 At-Tabari 18:156.

iii fcZ-j} iArid Hanananfrom Us,} "This was gentleness from His Lord upon him."111 The apparent meaning is that Allah's statement Hananan (affection, compassion) is directly related to His statement, iand We gave him wisdom while yet a child.} meaning, "We gave him wisdom, compassion and purity." This means that he was a compassionate man, who was righteous. Hanan means the love for affection and tenderness (towards others). Concerning Allah's statement, iand Zakdtan,} This is related to His statement, iAnd Hananan} The word Zakah means purity from filth, wickedness and sins. Qatadah said, "The word Zakah means the righteous deed."*2 Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Jurayj both said,

“The righteous deed is the pure (Zakah) deed.”¹³¹ Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, «& } iand Zakatan,} “This means that he was a blessing.” iand he was pious.} (19 :13) At-Tabari 18:156. At-Tabari 18:159. At-Tabari 18:159.

237Surah 19. Maruam (12-15) (Part-16)_ meaning that he was pure and had no inclination to do sins Allah said; yji- Suit iAnd dutiful to his parents, and he was not arrogant or disobedient After Allah mentioned Yahya’s obedience to his Lord and that Allah created him full of mercy, purity and piety, He attached to it his obedience to his parents and his good treatment of them. Allah mentioned that he refrained from disobeying them in speech, actions, commands and prohibitions. Due to tliis Allah says, iatid he was not arrogant or disobedient.} Then, after mentioning these beautiful characteristics, Allah mentions his reward for this, vi-ri fyj (y. iAnd Salam (peace) be on him the day he was bom, and the\ day he dies, and the day he loill be raised up to life (again)!} This means that he had security and safety in these three circumstances. Sufyan bin TJaynah said, “The loneliest that a man will ever feel is in three situations. The first situation is on the day that he is bom, when he sees himself coming out of what he was in. The second situation is on the day that he dies, when he sees people that he will not see anymore. The third situation is on the day when he is resurrected, when he sees himself in the great gathering. Allah has exclusively honored Yahya, the son of Zakariyya, by granting him peac; in these situations. Allah says, y , > '•> T -v. fyj -‘b iAnd Salam (peace) be on him the day he was bom, and the day he dies, and the day he will be raised up to life (again)!} This narration was reported by Ibn Jarir, from Ahmad bin Mansur Al-Marwazi, from Sadaqah bin Al-Fadl, from Sufyan bin TJaynah. At-Jabari 18:159, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:486.

r*n 1/rt) '->y*i(yj j (*j— j 4-^*b^>-cr>; / y • . > * ' ""1 ^2. .£, Z^/, / ,***•• C^cJIs L\$J Li>JjL\$!) [llL-yl^ U—Lc iii) til>j ^sTJs\$ifiiigjiZiffiji C"yy I'llV ' " 1^0,4^1c.y4j^A>xjJj <j\^ ^jJjJB -'*.£ ^ * JL /- ^*> ^ *->*'£^ A. y / / ^ Ia<-L>»U IX—^3Uj^4^<b ^^ ^ 'Sx' ~ ' =>jjIa la / / ,/j' > ^ . /•> ^ ^ >1 (<v- vi^Ji' 4 bl^4 Lflii ,j» OJUu' (*4i/> ojje£ “vi' ^~Jj (+i[UL_JU kCtr vJl> 10^ yj LjJ J^i V s' />^J > >1 « ol '&«* J~*y\ c)[*~&j Jy~j 0 L*jJ, Jti ^ wLL£» .ft.^zErraj •* &'* > l* -• «•'- (HJ [»Jc 4 ^iri 4' '^ lk{±> J \$ '& - i^j jli i /****' i.: // / >/' •s' ' 4-r^j *^j'* 0y 4^ylL^ £' t> 426. And mention in the Book, Maryam, when she withdrew in seclusionfrom herfamily to placefacing east.} 427. She placed a screen before them; then We sent to her Our Ruh, and he appeared before her in the form of a man in all respects.} 428. She said: "Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious (Allah)from you, ifyou dofeare Allah."} }19. (The angel) said: "I am only a messengerfrom your Lord, (to announce) to you the gift ofa righteous son."} 420. She said: "How can I have a son when no man has touched me, nor am I Baghiyya?"} 422. He said: "Thus says your Lord: ‘That is easy for Me (Allah). And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind and a mercy from Us (Allah), and it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah).’ ”}

The Story ofMaryam and Al-Masih (*isa) I After Allah, the Exalted, mentioned the story of Zakariyya, and that He blessed him with a righteous, purified and blessed child even in his old age while his wife was barren, He then mentions the story of Maryam. Allah informs of His granting her a child named ‘Isa without a father being involved (in Her pregnancy). Between these two stories there is an appropriate and similar relationship. Due to their closeness in meaning, Allah mentioned them here together, as well as in Surahs Al ‘Imran and Al-Anbiya’. Allah has mentioned these stories to show His servants His ability, the might of His authority and that He has power over all things. Allah says,

And mention in the Book, Maryam She was Maryam bint Imran from the family lineage of Dawud. She was from a good and wholesome family of the Children of Israel. Allah mentioned the story of her mother's pregnancy with her in Surah Al 'Imran, and that she (Maryam's mother) dedicated her freely for the service of Allah. This meant that she dedicated the child (Maryam) to the service of the Masjid of the Sacred House (in Jerusalem). Thus, they (Zakariyya, Maryam's mother and Maryam) were similar in that aspect. So her Lord (Allah) accepted her with goodly acceptance. He made her grow in a good manner. 3:37) Thus, Maryam was raised among the Children of Israel in an honorable way. She was one of the female worshippers, well-known for her remarkable acts of worship, devotion and perseverance. She lived under the care of her brother-in-law, Zakariyya, who was a Prophet of the Children of Israel at that time. He was a great man among them, whom they would refer to in their religious matters. Zakariyya saw astonishing miracles occur from her that amazed him. 'Jk iLS Ui jtf lijy Jio CjS"

Every time Zakariyya altered the Mihrab to (visit) her, he found her supplied with sustenance. He said: "O Maryam! From where have you got this?" She said, "This is from Allah." Verily, Allah provides to whom He wills, without limit. [3:37] It has been mentioned that he would find her with winter fruit during the summer and summer fruit during the winter. This has already been explained in Surah Al 'Imran. Then, when Allah wanted to grant her His servant and Messenger, Isa, one of the five Great Messengers. 44-44 1st is she withdrew in seclusion from her family to place facing [19:16] This means that she withdrew from them and secluded herself from them. She went to the eastern side of the Sacred Masjid (in Jerusalem). It is reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Verily, I am the most knowledgeable of Allah's creation of why the Christians took the east as the direction of devotional worship. They did because of Allah's statement, 'When she withdrew in seclusion from her family to a place facing east.' Therefore, they took the birthplace of 'Isa as their direction of worship."111 Concerning Allah's statement, 4She placed a screen before them;} This means that she hid herself from them and concealed herself. Then, Allah sent Jibril to her. 41*4&4 and he appeared before her in the form of a man in all respects.} [19:17 At-Tabari 18:162. The chain for this particular narration has a deficiency in it. Ibn Kathir mentions a number of narrations about this Ayah, after which he says, "And Allah knows best."

This means that he came to her in the form of a perfect and complete man. Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj, Wahb bin Munabbih and As-Suddi all commented on Allah's statement, then We sent to her Our Ruh,} "It means Jibril." iL; J jfrl £&} iShe said: "Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah."} This means that when the angel (Jibril) appeared to her in the form of a man, while she was in a place secluded by herself with a partition between her and her people, she was afraid of him and thought that he wanted to rape her. Therefore, she said, cJ* 4 JL M iVerily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah.} She meant, "If you fear Allah," as a means of reminding him of Allah. This is what is legislated in defense against (evil), so that it may be repulsed with ease. Therefore, the first thing she did was try to make him fear Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. Ibn Jarir reported from 'Asim that Abu Wa'il said when mentioning the story of Maryam, "She knew that the pious person would refrain (from committing evil) when she said, t' t'lj) ' V\ 'CSC o\, i"Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah." He said: "I am only a messenger from your Lord..."} This means that the angel said to her in response, and in order)

remove the fear that she felt within herself, "I am not what think, but I am the messenger of your Lord." By this he meant; "Allah has sent me to you."² It is said that when she mentioned the (Name of the) Most Beneficent (Ar-Rahman), Jibril fell upon her; and returned to his true form (as an angel). He responded, to her, as recorded in At-Tabari 18:163. 121 At-Tabari 18:164.

o!?!j ini 4L3 j LI uji) I am only a messenger from your Lord, to provide to you the gift of a righteous son.' 4 \$ <^b} ^S/ie said: "How can I have a son..." } This means that Maryam was amazed at this. She said, "How can I have a son?" She said this to mean, "In what way would a son be born to me when I do not have a husband and I do not commit any wicked acts (i.e. fornication)?" For this reason she said, when no man has touched me, nor am I Baghiyya? } The Baghiyya is a female fornicator. For this reason, a Hadith has been reported prohibiting the money earned from Baghiyya. iHe said: "Thus said your Lord: 'That is easy for Me (Allah)...'" } This means that the angel said to her in response to her question, "Verily, Allah has said that a boy will be born from you even though you do not have a husband and you have not committed any lewdness. Verily, He is Most Able to do whatever He wills." Due to this, he (Jibril) conveyed Allah's Words, iAnd (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind } This means a proof and a sign for mankind of the power of their Maker and Creator, Who diversified them in their creation. He created their father, Adam, without a male (father) or female (mother). Then, He created Hawwa' (Adam's spouse) from a male (father) without a female (mother). Then, He created the rest of their progeny from male and female, Ahmad 1 :235, Al-Bukhari 2237, Muslim 1567.

except "Isa. He caused 'Isa to be born from a female without, a male. Thus, Allah completed the four types of creation (of the human being), which proves the perfection of His power and the magnificence of His authority. There is no god worthy of worship except Him and there is no true Lord other than Him. Concerning Allah's statement, iand a mercy from Us, } This means, "We will make this boy a mercy from Allah and a Prophet from among the Prophets. He will call to the worship of Allah and monotheistic belief in Him. This is as Allah, the Exalted, said in another Ayah, 4 pfs j) £t—J* ii-' *4 'nil' 0) 4 (4^=VJ t;jJ' i(Remember) when the angels said : "O Maryam! Verily, Allah gives you the good news of a Word from Him, his name will be Al-Masih, 'Isa, the son of Maryam, held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and he will be one of those who are near to Allah. And he will speak to the people, in the cradle and in manhood, and he will be one of the righteous. \$> (3 :45-46 This means that he will call to the worship of his Lord in his cradle and while and adult. Concerning His statement, j): (J£&} iand it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah). } This is the completion of Jibril's dialogue with Maryam. [He informed her that this matter was preordained by Allah's power and will. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, 41'—fra -* £&>} iand it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah). } "This means that Allah determined to do this, so there is no avoiding it." m At-Tabari 18:165.

4 ;^r;U--ju UJj c-i^=>j UIa jld 422. So she conceived him, and she withdrew with him to a remote place. } 23 . And the pains of childbirth drove her to the trunk of a date palm. She said: "Would that I had died before this, and had been forgotten and out of sight!" } The Conception and the Birth Allah, the Exalted, informs about Maryam that when Jibril had spoken to her about what Allah said, she accepted the decree of Allah. Many scholars of the predecessors (Salaf) have mentioned that at this point the angel (who was Jibril) blew into the opening of the garment that she was wearing. Then the breath descended until it entered into her vagina and she conceived the child by the leave of Allah.

Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "When she conceived him and filled her water jug (at a well), she returned (to her people). After this, her menstrual bleeding ceased and she experienced what the pregnant woman experiences of sickness, hunger, change of color and there was even a change in the manner of her speech. After this, no people came to visit any house like they did the house of Zakariyya. The word spread among the Children of Israel and the people were saying, 'Verily, her partner (in fornication) was Yusuf, because there was no one else in the temple with her except him.' So she hid herself from the people and placed a veil between herself and them. No one saw her and she did not see anyone else." Allah said; 4And the pains of childbirth drove her to the trunk of a date palm.} This means that her pains of labor compelled her to go to the trunk of a date-palm tree that was at the place where she had secluded herself. The scholars differed over its location. As- Suddi said, "Her place of seclusion was to the east and that

was where she would pray at the Sacred House of Jerusalem. "1 ' Wahb bin Munabbih said, "She ran away and when she reached an area between Ash-Sham¹²¹ and Egypt, she was overcome by labor pains."3 ' In another narration from Wahb, he said, "This took place eight miles from the Sacred House of Jerusalem in a village that was known Bayt Al-Lahm (Bethlehem)."4 * I say, there are Hadiths above; the Isra.' (Night Journey of the Prophet (s)) that are reported An-Nasal on the authority of Anas,⁵ ' and Al-Bayhaqi on the authority of Shadad bin Aws, that say that this took place Bait Al-Lahm.*6 ' Allah knows best. This is what is well known that the people all relate from each other. The Christians have no doubt held that the place of this occurrence was Bethlehem and this is what all the people relate. It has been related in a Hadith also, if the Hadith is authentic. Allah says, informing about her. It is that * A // ,//y \Xa Jj cJuy 4She said: "Would that I had died before this, and had been forgotten and out of sight!" In this is an evidence of the permissibility to wish for death when a calamity strikes. She knew that she was going to be tested with the birth, the people would not assist her, and they would not believe her story. After she was known as a devout worshipper among them, they now thought that she had become a fornicating whore. She said, jj j-. {Would that I had died before this,} [2 | [31 I4 1 (61 At-Tabari 18:161. Greater Syria At-Tabari 18:170. At-Jabari 18:170. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 1 :22 1 . Most scholars consider the text that include Bethlehem as a place of prayer on the night of Isra' to be unauthentic Dald'ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :355

She said this to mean before this situation. and I had been forgotten and out of sight!} This means, "I wish I had not been created and I was nothing." This was mentioned by Ibn 'Abbas. 1 11 Qatadah said, and I had been forgotten and out of sight!"} "This means something unknown, forgotten and no one knew who I was." sb** lily Ji If*?6 oi j ty/ , > / /< { // / f// V, ^ // OjJb \Jt Uj* wife jS 1/\y* Cf*^, 424. 77ien he cried unto her from below her, saying: "Grieve not: your Lord has provided a Sariy under you."} 425. "And shake the trunk of date palm towards you, it will let fall fresh ripe dates upon you."} 426. "So eat and drink and rejoice. And if you see any human being, say: 'Verily, I have vowed a fast for the Most Gracious so I shall not speak to any human being today,."} What was said to Her after the Birth Some reciters read the Ayah as, (Who was below her) Meaning the one who was below her called to her. Others recited it as, if from below her} With the meaning of a preposition (from) instead of a pronoun (who). The scholars of Tafsir have differed over the interpretation of who was calling out. Al-'Awfi and others in At-Tabari 18:172.

reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, oi }Tlten cried unto herfrom below her,} “This is referring to Jibril * because Isa did not speak until she brought him to her people.” Similarly, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Amr bin Maymtin, As-Suddi and Qatadah all said, “Verily, this is referring to the angel Jibril.”¹²¹ This means that he (Jibril) called out to her from the bottom of the valley. Mujahid said, iTheti cried unto herfrom below her,} “This is referring to ‘Isa bin Maryam.” Likewise, ‘Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ma‘mar that Qatadah said that Al-Hasan said, “This is referring to her son (‘Isa).” This is also one of the two opinions reported from Said bin Jubayr - that it was her so i, ‘Isa, speaking. Said said, “Have you not heard Allah saying, iThen she pointed to him.} Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir preferred this opinion in his Tafsir. Allah said, iGrieve not He called to her saying, “Do not grieve.” lili iyour Lord has provided a Sariy under you.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri and ShulDah reported from Abu Ishaq that Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib said, Tb- kl J*} iyour Lord has provided a Sariy under you.} At-Tabari 18:173. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 18:173.

“This means a small stream.”¹¹¹ Likewise, ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Sariy means a river.”^{*2} ‘Amr bin Maymun held the same view, as he said, “It means a river for her to drink from.”^{*3} ‘Mujahid said, “It means river in the Syrian language.”^{*4} ‘Sato bin Jubayr said, “Sariy is a small flowing river.”^{s *} Others said that Sariy refers to ‘Isa. This was said by Al-Hasan, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, Muhammad bin ‘Abbad bin Jafar, and it is one of the two opinions reported from Qatadah. It is also the view of ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. However, the first view seems to be the most obvious meaning. For this reason, Allah said after it, tit, 4And shake the trunk of date palm tozwards you,4 meaning, “Grab the trunk of the date-palm tree and shake it towards yourself.” Therefore, Allah blessed her by giving her food and drink. Then He said, ^0 lSjJ>j My 4It ivill let fall fresh ripe dates upon you . So eat and drink and rejoice. Meaning to be happy. This is why ‘Amr bin Maymun said, “Nothing is better for the woman confined in childbed than dried dates and fresh dates.” Then he recited this noble Ayah.⁶ Concerning Allah’s statement, 4And ifyou see any human being,} This means any person that you see, At-Tabari 18:175. ^{*21} At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. '6| At-Tabari 18:179.

-yf *y* CiJA. 41 44-*} 4Say : ‘Verily, I have voived a fast unto the Most Gracious (Allah) so I shall not speak to any human being today.} Meaning, by signaling with gestures, not a statement speech. This is so that she does not negate her oath itself, pii=J A>} 4so I shall not speak to any human being today.} Anas bin Malik commented on, iA~A ojj; 4',^ 41 have voived a fast unto the Most Gracious} He said; “A vow of silence. * Likewise said Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak.^{*21} The meaning here is that in their Law, when fasting, it was forbidden for them to eat and speak. As-Suddi, Qatadah ajid ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd have all stated this view. ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd said, “When Isa said to Maryam, 4Grieve not} She said, ‘How can I not grieve when you are with me and I have no husband nor am I an owned slave woman? What excuse do I have with the people? Woe unto me, if I h!ad only died before this, and had been a thing forgotten and unknown.’ Then, isa said to her, ‘I will suffice you withj a statement, (4^=' by*> lt^A ‘iyj* 41 44-* '-**-* y; bb} 4And ifyou see any human being, say : ‘Verily, I have voived] a fast unto the Most Gracious so I shall not speak to any\ human being this day.’}’ All of this is from the speech of “Isa to his mother.” Wahb said the same as well. ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 18:182-183. At-Tabari 18:182-183. At-Tabari 18:183, Al-Qurtubi 11 :98.

mm r-v hot /. * *? > *' ' f \ \ i " -. / ^ "C • "l-f ^ -iai ^ ^>*Ujfcru l)jy*^i<jt~djC^=\a^KjL* (_ji*>-Jf|p^ • v »/ // / / f" // ,^4x /y i . I . x // 4-4!^!^?&P Vjk=r)\j Oi‘-r’\)>~t '<wili>-ls £j3J j*~j£~A JJb »_JJ_£ls h^0 jn^! «®» % ye Xa vf;> ., a> lr*' o^ U iy/A oi-lī vs (la> *iL*^ oiK^ l*y O* «JL£” ijJU OjU-li Jfc iWjllij’ «j .J 33f Gp’* ji’ ^ (* ci) IC>W* h:~t ^%iM^~ pj a^i !hJ \$:&. £ ^3j ;r>;iiii ijii: cs.j ‘-a->>4 f->y fji i> rT,£- 14’ Then she brought him to her people, carry- ing him. They said: "O Mary! Indeed you have brought a thing Fariy."> "O sister ofHarm! Yourfather was not a man who used to commit adultery, nor your mother iwas an unchaste woman."} /i\ / <• « >:LSj» dJ .a) 429. Then she pointed to him. They said: “How can we talk to one who is a child in the cradle?”} 430. He said: “ Verily , I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet;”} 431. “And He has made me blessed xoherever I be, and has enjoined on me [Axusatii] Salah and Zakdh, as long as 1 live.”} 432. “And to be dutifid to my mother, and made me not arrogant, unblessed.”} 433. “And Salam (peace) be upon me the day 1 xvas born, and the day 1 die, and the day I shall be raised alive!”}

Maryam with Al-Masih before the People, Their Rejection ofHer and His Reply to Them Allah, the Exalted, informs of Maryam’s situation when she was commanded to fast that day and not to speak to any human being. For verily, her affair would be taken care of ant! her proof would be established. Thus, she accepted tlie command of Allah and she readily received His decree. She took her child and brought him to her people, carrying him. When they saw her like this they made a big deal about her situation and they sternly protested against of it, and ! iThey said: “O Mary! Indeed you have brought a thing Fariy Fariy means a mighty thing. This was said by Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.^ ' Ibn Abi Hatim reported from Nawf Al-Bikall that he said, “Her people went out searching for her, she was from a family that was blessed with prophethood and nobility. However, they could not find any trace of her. They came across a cow herder and they asked him, ‘Have ycu seen a girl whose description is such and such?’ He replied, ‘No, but tonight 1 saw my cows doing something that I’ve nevsr seen them do before.’ They asked, What did you see?’ He said, Tonight I saw them prostrating in the direction of that valley.”121 ‘Abdullah bin Ziyad said (adding to the narration), “I memorized from Sayyar that he (the cattle herder) said, 1 saw a radiant light.’ ” So they went towards the direction that jie told him, and Maryam was coming towards them from that direction. When she saw them she sat down and she was holding her child in her lap. They came towards her until they were standing over her. ! iThey said: “O Mary! Indeed you have brought a mighty thing (Fariy).” At-Tabari 18:185. 121 AtTabari 18:187.

iThen she pointed to him.} “She indicated, ‘Speak to him.’ They then said, ‘After she has come to us with this calamity, stje now commands us to speak to one who is a child in tlie cradle!’”111 As-Suddi said, “When she pointed to him they became angry and said, ‘Her mocking us, to the extent of commanding us to speak to this child, is worse to us than her fornication.’ ” itt4340^^ iThey said: "How can we talk to one who is a child in the cradle?"}™ This means, “How can someone speak who is in his cradle, in the state of infancy and a child?” Isa said, ^3 ju 4Verily, I am a servant ofAllah,} The first thing that he said was a declaration of the lofty honor of his Lord and His being free of having a child. Also, lie affirmed that he himselfwas a worshipper of his Lord. Allah said, it 33r \$He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet.} This was a declaration of innocence for his mother from the immorality that was attributed to her. Nawf Al-Bikall said, “When they said what they said to his mother, he (Isa) was nursing from her breast. At their statement he released the breast from his mouth

and reclined on his left saying, it is verily, I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet.} And he continued speaking until he said, it is 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:507. 121 At-Tabari 18:189.

254 TafsTr Ibn Kathir as long as I live.}" Concerning his statement, 4And He has made me blessed wherever I be, Mujahid, 'Amr bin Qays and Ath-Thawri all said that this means, "And He made me a teacher of goodness." * In another narration from Mujahid, he said, "A person of great benefit."*2 Ibn Jarir reported from Wuhayb bin Al-Ward, a freed slave of the Bani Makhzum tribe, that he said, "A scholar met another scholar who had more knowledge than himself. So he said to him, "May Allah have mercy upon you, what acts of mine should I perform openly?" The other replied, 'Commanding good and forbidding evil, for verily, it is the religion of Allah, which He sent His Prophets with to His servants.' The scholars have indeed agreed upon the statement of Allah, 4And He has made me blessed wherever I be,} Then it was said, What was his blessing?' He (Wuhayb) replied, 'Commanding good and forbidding evil wherever he was.' *3 His saying, 4and He has enjoined on me [Awsdni] Salah and Zakdh, as long as I live .} This is similar to the statement of Allah to Muhammad jfa, 4And worship your Lord until there comes unto you the certainty (i.e. death).} [15:99] 'Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Qasim reported from Malik bin Anas that he commented on Allah's statement, At-Tabari 18:191. At-Tabari 18:191. * At-Tabari 18:191.

255 Surah 19. Maryam (27-33) (Part-16) and He has enjoined on me [Awsdni] Salah and Zakdh, as long as I live. He said, "Allah informed him of what would be of his affair until his death. This is the firmest evidence against the people who deny Allah's preordained decree. ",1) Concerning Allah's statement, 44& 4And to be dutiful to my mother.} This means, "He (Allah) has commanded me to treat my mother well." He mentioned this after mentioning obedience to his Lord, Allah. This is because Allah often combines the command to worship Him with obedience to the parents. This is similar to Allah's statement, 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him and that you be dutiful to your parents.} [17:23] And He, the Exalted, said, fv 3* J%=& 4Cive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} [31:14] Concerning his statement, 4^ 'jL*- and He made me not arrogant, unblessed .} This means, "He (Allah) has not made me too proud or arrogant to worship Him, obey Him and be dutiful to my mother, and thus be unblessed;" Concerning Allah's statement, 4 rr ^ cfj fyj 4And Salam (peace) be upon me the day I was born, and the day I die, and the day I shall be raised alive!} This is his affirmation that Tie is a worshipper of Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, and that he is a creature created by Allah. He (Isa) will live, die and be resurrected, just like the HI Al-Qurtubi 11:103. That is, he understood Awsdni with (its alternative meaning: "He decreed for me.").

256 TafsTr Ibn Kathir other creatures that Allah has created. However, he will have peace in these situations, which are the most difficult situations for Allah's creatures.' May Allah's peace and blessings be upon him. J jl), C. f-j* {j) -i>>> 'jc* oiliu *ji jjj ff'dfcs £ £) jji Qu fit iji 4-]5f7^4»* ^y, 4r*~* ciSJJ Jr*. ^34. Shc/i is 7sfl, son of Maryam. Qawlal-Haqq [it is a statement of truth] about which they doubt (or dispute).} 435. It befits not (the majesty of) Allah that He should beget a son. Glorified be He. Wlten He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be!" - and it is.} 436. ['Isa said] : "And verily, Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So ivorship Him. That is the straight path."} 437. Then the sects differed, so ivoe unto the disbelievers from the meeting of a great Day.} 'Isa is the Servant of Allah and not His Son

Allah, the Exalted, says to His Messenger Muhammad jg, This is the story which We have related to you about Isa,' upon him be peace. 4-jja-j *j> i(It is) a statement of truth about which they doubt.} This means that the people of falsehood and the people of truth are in disagreement, of those who believe in him and those who disbelieve believe in him. For this reason most of the reciters recited this Ayah with Qawlul-Haqq (statement of truth) as the subject, referring to 'Isa himself. 'Asim and 'Abdullah bin 'Amir both recited it Qawlul-Haqq (statement of truth) referring to the story in its entirety that the people differed about. It is reported from Ibn Mas'ud that he recited it as Qalal-Haqq, which means that he (Isa) said the truth. The recitation of the Ayah with the Qawlul-Haqq being the subject referring to 'Isa, is the most apparent meaning 111 At-Tabari 18:194.

grammatically. It has support for it in the statement of Allah [after the story of Isa], 4(This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt> [3:60] When Allah mentioned that He created him as a servant and a Prophet, He extolled Himself, the Most Holy, by saying, 4It befits not (the majesty of) Allah that He should beset a son. Glorified be He.} Means glory be unto Him, He is far exalted above that which these ignorant, wrongdoing, transgressing people say about Him. 4m jr i!& 0 ! iWhen He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be!" - and if I is.} Whenever He wants something, He merely commands it and it happens as He wills. This is as Allah says, j*j' 'jC> y'J £££ ii' oj& &j oi iVerily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then said to him: "Be" and he was. (This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt.} [3:59-60] 'Isa commanded the Worship of Allah Alone, then the People differed after Him Allah said; ; / .< ' ' > »* ' ' .V ^ 'XS> 4 jhjjj Jp AS' 4And verily, Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him. That is the straight path.} Among those things which Isa said to his people while he was in his cradle is that Allah was his Lord and their Lord, and] he commanded them to worship Him alone. He said,

258 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iSo iworship Him. That is the straight path .) Meaning, "That which I have come to you with from Allah is the straight path." This means that the path is correct; whoever follows it will be rightly guided and whoever opposes it will deviate and go astray. Allah's statement, «M) iThen the sects differed,) means that the opinions of the People of the Book differed concerning Isa even after the explanation of his affair and the clarification of his situation. They disagreed about his being the servant of Allah, His Messenger, and His Word that He cast upon Maryam and a spirit from Himself. So a group of them - who were the majority of the Jews (may Allah's curses be upon them) - determined that he was a child of fornication and that his speaking in his cradle was merely sorcery. Another group said that it was Allah Who was speaking (not Isa). Others said that he (Isa) was the son of Allah. Some said that he was the third part of a divine trinity with Allah. Yet, others said that he was the servant of Allah and His Messenger. This latter view is the statement of truth, which Allah guided the believers to. A report similar with this meaning has been reported from 'Amr bin Maymun, Ibn Jurayj, Qatadah and others from the Salaf (predecessors) and the Khalaf (later generations). Allah said, oi i>j& Jo*) iso zoee unto the disbelievers from the meeting of a great Day.) This is a threat and severe warning for those who lie about Allah, invent falsehood and claim that He (Allah) has a son. However, Allah has given them respite until the Day of Resurrection, and He has delayed their term out of gentleness and confident reliance upon His divine decree overcoming them. Verily, Allah does not hasten the affair of those who disobey Him. This has been related in a Hadith collected in the Two Sahihs,

•cilL sA>-i lil JUKU ^U2 iul jj® • Verily, Allah gives respite to the wrongdoer until He seizes him and he will not be able to escape Him. Then, the Messenger of Allah recited the Ayah, i m i.4 U} /•& k ui. >j jtftit 5L\ hi 5a <fSi/c/i is the punishment of your Lord when He punishes the towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful, (and) severe [11:102] In the Two Sahilis it is also reported that the Messenger Allah 5e£ said, pf ur. aJ j JuL>w j* »l jJ- 'f • L*jj »No one is more patient with something harmful that he hears than Allah. Verily, they attribute to Him a son, while He is the One Wlw provides them sustenance and good health .»[21 Allah says. 4 i\ IjJj lyJu- jZ *liUi TIAi LA 0;l^==y^ «And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then I punished it. And to me is the (final) return (of all).} [22:48] Allah, the Exalted, also says, fj) Jt-ji o .ltll !»-* Viik ii” 4 J— .V 4Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror.}\ 14:42] This is the reason that Allah says here, tf. 4t-l* jt jiy? iSo woe unto the disbelievers from the meeting of a great Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 : 1997 Fath Al-Bari 10:527, Muslim 4 :2160.

Day.) referring to the Day of Resurrection. It has been related in an authentic Hadlth that is agreed upon (in Al-Bukhari and Muslim), on the authority of TJbadah bin As-Samit who said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, j\j ojlp V ajJ-j Jill VI iJ) V Cl? Jtfd jUij £>ji jf_j f)\ UliJ? IjjCJl jIS La 41><J| 4JJ I <Jl3oI olA^ioeyer testifies that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah alone, Who has no partners, and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger, and that ‘Isa was Allah's servant and Messenger, and His Word that He cast upon Maryam, and a spirit from Him, and that Paradise and Hell are both real, then Allah will admit him into Paradise regardless of whatever he did.^ 1] s/y.* '<*' '.iu > >• i^i tZiSst > *> 4 Qp fa ctj ^ A> fa ^ h 438. How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us! But the wrongdoers today are in plain error.) 439. And warn them of the Day ofgriefand regrets, when the case has been decided, while (now) they are in a state of carelessness, and they believe not.) 440. Verily, We will inherit the earth and whatsoever is thereon. And to Us they all shall be returned.) The Disbeliever’s warning ofthe Day ofDistress Allah, the Exalted, says informing about the disbelievers on

the Day of Resurrection that they will be made to have the clearest hearing and sight. This is as Allah says, a. ..j b/tfu? Ifj il j&)) 4And ifyou only could see when the criminals hang their heads FathAl-Bari 6:546, Muslim 1 :57.

before their Lord (saying) : “Our Lord! We have now seen and heard.”} [32:12] They will say that when it will not benefit them, nor will it be of any use to them. If they had used these senses propeijly before seeing the torment, then it would have brought them some benefit and saved them from the Allah’s punishment. This is why Allah says, rr. }How clearly will they (disbelievers) see and hear,} This means that no one will hear and see better than they will. (j> } }the day when they will appear before Us.} The Day of Resurrection. }But the wrongdoers today are...} now, in the life of this! world, 4...in plain error.} They do not hear, see or think. When they are requested to follow guidance, they are not guided and they succumb to those things that do not benefit them. Then, Allah says, iAnd warn them of the Day ofgriefand regrets,} warn the creation of the Day of Distress, ^& iwhen the case has been decided,} when the people of Paradise and the people of Hell will be sorted out, and everyone will

reach his final abode which he was destined to remain in forever. ip. iwhile (now) they are} today, in the present life of this world.

262 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iin a state of carelessness.) with the warning of the Day of grief and regret, they are heedless. iand they believe not.) meaning they do not believe that it is true. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Sa'id said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, — jrr* ij0l jllil JjLij JI £j*}\ Jii lilt : Jli 1 1-La ofiyC Ji <l>Jl JaI U .'Jliii ijlllj yj :Jlj i l-U ojific Ja ijlljl Jiiu :JUj - :J15 - ^1)1 lJU^ .Jli ^ - :JU - Ua ^jC, :jjijij jy j>" 'ij l< • JI*3 uIA7ich the people of Paradise enter Paradise and the people of the Hellfire enter the Hellfire, death will be brought in the form of a handsome ram and it toill be placed between Paradise and the Hellfire. Then, it will be said, "O people of Paradise, do you know zohat this is?" Then, they will turn their gazes and look, and they will say, "Yes, this is death." Then, it will be said, "O people of the Hellfire, do you know zohat this is?" Then, they will turn their gazes and look, and they will say, "Yes, this is death." Then, the order zwill be given for it to be slaughtered and it zoill be said, "O people of Paradise, eternity and no more death, O people of Hellfire, eternity and no more death »" Then the Messenger of Allah j*r recited the Ayah, V fj iAnd zvani them of the Day ofgriefand regret, when the case has been decided, while (now) they are in a state of carelessness, and they believe not.) Then, the Messenger of Allah jg made a gesture with his hand and said,

«gjj i a. & j gi)i jil «77ic people of this life are in the state of heedlessness of this lifeV Thus recorded Imam Ahmad and it was also recorded by Al- Bukhari and Muslim in their Sahibs^ with wording similar 1o this. It is reported from ‘Abdullah bin Mas“ud that he mentioned a story in which he said, “There is not a soul except that it will see a residence in Paradise and a residence in the Hellfire, and this will be the Day of distress. So the people of the Hellfire will see the residence that Allah prepared for them ifthey had believed. Then, it will be said to them, If you had believed and worked righteous deeds, you would have had this, which you see in Paradise.’ Then, they will be overcome with distress and grief. Likewise, the people of Paradise will see the residence that is in the Hellfire and it will be said to them, If Allah had not bestowed His favor upon you (this would have been your place).’ ”13) Concerning Allah’s statement, & i/j J&R i Verily, We will inherit the earth and whatsoever is thereon. And to Us they all shall be returned.} Allah is informing that He is the Creator, the Owner and the Controller of all matters. All of the creation will be destroyed and only He, the Most High and Most Holy, will remain. There is no one who can claim absolute ownership and control of affairs besides Him. He is the Inheritor of all His creation. He is the Eternal, Who will remain after they are gone and He is the Judge of their affairs. Therefore, no soul will be done any injustice, nor wronged even the weight of a mosquito or an atom. Ahmad 9 :3. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :282 , Muslim 4 :2 188 At-Tabari , it is the first narration explaining Ayah no . 39 . See the section on the reports at the beginning of the book

^ rn r*A Italia T > y^ -t • x, '&ck)J&\£>J c£ 4^Jla Sr-Md^ dJUuj^j U^t^ii Utitli j^3U.>!) I <^>5 *WJi<j i £§liy^ kiLIJju"oUitiiobj^ll^ JU '-4)o'W— ojxioUj iiu jt.i^jfr^t Ibn Abi Hatim recor- ded that Hazm bin Abi Hazm Al-Quta‘! said, “Umar bin ‘Abdul-Aziz wrote to ‘Abdul-Hamid bin ‘Abdur-Rahman, who was the governor of Kufah: ‘Thus, to proceed: Verily, Allah prescribed death for His creatures when He created them and He determined their final destination. He said in that which He revealed in His truthful Book, which He guarded with His knowledge and made His angels testify to its preservation, that He will inherit the earth and all who are on it, and they will all bereturnedtoHim. 441.

And mention in the Book, Ibrahim. Verily, he was a man of truth, a Prophet. 442. When he said to his father : "O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?" } Ibn Abi Hatim 7 :2410.

265Siirah 19. Maryam (41-45) (Part-16) 443. "O my father! Verily, there has come to me the knowledge of that which came not unto you. So follow me, I will guide you to the straight path." } 444. "O my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily, Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Gracious." } 445. "O my father! Verily, I fear lest a torment from the Most Gracious should overtake you, so that you become a companion of Shaytan." } Ibrahim's Admonition of His Father Allah, the Exalted, tells His Prophet, Muhammad 4 And mention in the Book, Ibrahim. } "Recite this to your people who are worshipping idols and mention to them what happened with Ibrahim, the intimate Friend (Khalit) of the Most Beneficent. These idol worshippers (Arabs) are his descendants and they claim to follow his religion. Inform them that he was a truthful Prophet. Tell them about what took place with his father and how he forbade him from worshipping idols." Ibrahim said, 4 <cl dU£ Sfj ^ 40 my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees] not and cannot avail you in anything? } Meaning that these idols will not benefit you, nor can they protect you from any harm. jiJ U jiff <4*^ -** til 40 my father! Verily, there has come to me the knowledge of that which came not unto you. } This means, "Even though I am from your loins and you see me as inferior to you because I am your son, know that I have received knowledge from Allah that you do not know and it has not reached you." luS 4 So follow me, I will guide you to the straight path. } I

meaning, "a straight path that will carry you to the desired objective and save you from that which is dreaded (Hell)." 40 my father! Worship not Shaytan.) This is means, "Do not obey him by worshipping these idols. He invites to this (idolatry) and he is pleased with it." This is as Allah says, S^*^' sj fSU xfiS ff) 4 Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan . Verily, he is a plain enemy to you.) (36:60) Allah also says, V! i They invoke nothing but females [idols] besides Him (Allah), and they invoke nothing but Shaytdn, a persistent rebel 1 [4:117] Concerning Allah's statement, <i* c£x# u) i Verily, Shaytdn has been a rebel against the Most Gracious.) This means obstinate and too arrogant to obey his Lord. Therefore, Allah expelled him and made him an outcast. Therefore, "do not follow him or you will become like him." S' 4 40 my father! Verily, I fear lest a torment from the Most Gracious should overtake you.) "because of your associating partners with Allah and your disobedience in what I am commanding you with." lu SjSi» 4 so that you become a companion of Shaytdn .) This means, there will be no one who will protect you, or help you, or assist you, except Iblls. However, neither he, nor anyone else, has any power over the outcome of matters.

Si ral i 19. Maryam (46-48) (Part-16) Following him will only cause you to be surrounded by the torment (of Allah)." This is as Allah says, & ^ ^ Jj\jc <By Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you, but Shaytan made their deeds fair seeming to them. So he is their helper today (in this world), and theirs will be a painful torment. [16:63] JU n lit* ' } oJ f'fi ly cJ 4-^J f of ot fjiy-oi Uj fJ — 'j ! y tii»- ^ xjj ^ A'- -' 1— . 'Vllil jf Vi jfj yj'S <46. He (the father) said: "Do you revile my gods, O Ibrahim If you stop not (this), I will La'arjumannak . So get away from me Maliyan." } <47. Ibrahim said: "Peace be on you! I will ask forgiveness of my Lord for you. Verily, He is unto me Hajfyyan . } <46. And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call

upon my Lord, and I certainly hope that I shall not be unblessed in my invocation to my Lord."} The Reply of Ibrahim's Father Allah, the Exalted, informs of the reply of Ibrahim's father to his son, Ibrahim, in reference to what he was calling him [to. He said, <Do you revile my gods, O Ibrahim?} This means, "If you do not want to worship them (the idols) and you are not pleased with them, then at least stop cursing, abusing, and reviling them. For verily, if you do not cease, I will punish you, curse you and revile you." This is the meaning of his statement; iLa'arjumannaka

Ibn 'Abbas, As-Suddi, Ibn Jurayj, Ad-Dahhak and others said this. 111 ' Concerning His statement, iSo get away from me Maliyati .} Mujahid, Tkrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Mujahid bin Ishaq all said, "Maliyan means forever."121 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "For a long time."131 As-Suddi said, &#>} 4So get away from me safely Maliyan .} "This means forever."141 Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-'Awfi both reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4So get away from me safely Maliyan. "This means to go away in peace and safety before you are afflicted with a punishment from me." Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, 'Atiyah Al-Jadali, Malik and others said the same. This is also the view preferred by Ibn Jarir. The Reply of Allah's Friend (Khalit) With this, Ibrahim said to his father, f&} iPeace be on you!} This is as Allah said concerning the description of the believers, &} iand when the foolish address them (with bad words) they say , "Salaman [peace]." [25:63] Allah also says, ^5 v0 % pj &A u tfg ^ i; At-Tabari 18:205. At-Tabari 18:205,206. At-Tabari 18:205. At-Tabari 18:206.

Sitrah 19. Maruam (46-48) (Part-16) 269 4Arid when they hear Al-Laghwa (false speech), they withdraw from it and say: "To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant."} [28:55]

The meaning of Ibrahim's statement to his father,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3434–3451]

iPeace be on you!} "You will not receive any insult or harm from me." This is due to the respect and honor of fatherhood. 41 will ask forgiveness of my Lord for you.} meaning "But, I will ask Allah to guide you and forgive you for your sin." ^^ >\$} iVerily, He is unto me Hafiyya.} Ibn 'Abbas and others said that Hafvyyan means, "Kind.j Meaning, "since He guided me to worship Him and direct my religious devotion to Him alone." As-Suddi said, "Al-Hafi is Cj>ne Who is concerned with his (Ibrahim's) affair." Thus, Ibrahim sought forgiveness for his father for a very long time, even after he migrated to Ash-Sham. He continued to seek forgiveness for him even after building the Sacred Masjid (in Makkah) and after the birth of his two sons, Ismail and Ishaq. This can be seen in his statement, fX\$vOX 4& iOur Lord! Forgive me and my parents, and (all) the believers on the Day when the reckoning will be established.} [14:41] From this tradition, during the beginning stages of Islam, jthe Muslims used to seek forgiveness for their relatives and their family members who were polytheists. They did this following the way of Ibrahim, the Khalil (Friend) of Allah, until Allah revealed, 111 At-Jabari 18:207.

liii fC. bv \ ijlte i\ , '*Z jd\j -j 111! JjK" J. it > s >>' Oji JjAyO ilndeed there has been an excellent example for you in Ibrahim and those with him, iwhen they said to their people: "Verily, you are free from you and whatever you worship besides Allah.") [60:4] Until Allah's statement, 4 jj ji' Oi ilM lAlpI

Except the saying of Ibrahim to his father: "Verily, I will ask forgiveness (from Allah) for you, but I have no power to do anything for you before Allah.") [60:4] meaning, except for this statement, so do not follow it. Then Allah explains that Ibrahim abandoned this statement and retracted it. Allah, the Exalted, says, "And Ibrahim's invoking for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he had made to him. But when it became clear to him that he is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily, Ibrahim was forbearing." [9:114] Concerning Allah's statement, "And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call upon my Lord," This means, "And I worship my Lord alone, associating no partners with Him." See the Tafsir of Stirat At-Tawbah 9:114.

Asa (I hope) here means that which will necessarily occur and not that which is hoped for from the impossible. For verily, he (Ibrahim) is the leader of the Prophets other than Muhammad. So when he had turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one of them We made a Prophet. And We gave them of Our mercy, and We granted them Sidqin 'Aliyyan on the tongues. Allah gave Ibrahim Ishaq and Ya'qub. Allah, the Exalted, says that when the Friend of Allah (Ibrahim) withdrew from his father and his people for the sake of Allah, Allah gave him in exchange those who were better than them. He gave him Ishaq (Isaac) and Ya'qub (Jacob), meaning his son, Ishaq, and Ishaq's son, Ya'qub. This is Allah said in another Ayah, "And after Ishaq, of Ya'qub." [11:71] There is no difference of opinion about Ishaq being the father of Ya'qub. This is what is recorded in the Qur'an in Suran Al-Baqarah. "Were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub?"

272 fakir Ibn Kathir he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, "We shall worship your God the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Isma'il and Ishaq." [2:133] Allah only mentioned Ishaq and Ya'qub here to show that He made Prophets from among his descendants and successors in order to give him relief and happiness in his life. This is why Allah says, "And each one of them We made a Prophet [19:49] If Ya'qub had not become a Prophet in the lifetime of Ibrahim, then Allah would not have limited the promise of prophethood to him, but He would have mentioned his son Yusuf as well. For verily, Yusuf was also a Prophet, just as the Messenger of Allah said in a Hadith whose authenticity is agreed upon, when he was asked who was the best of people. He said, "The Prophet of Allah, Yusuf, the son of the Prophet of Allah Ya'qub, the son of the Prophet of Allah Ishaq, the son of the Friend of Allah Ibrahim." In another wording of this Hadith, he said, "Verily, the noble one is the son of the noble one, who is the son of the noble one, who is the son of the noble one. That is Yusuf, the son of Ya'qub, the son of Ishaq, the son of Ibrahim." Concerning Allah's statement, "And We gave them of Our mercy, and We granted Sidqin 'Aliyyan on the tongues" Fath Al-Bari 8 :212 . '2| Fath Al-Bari 6 :460 .

'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Sidqin 'Aliyyan means the good praise." As-Suddi and Malik bin Anas said the same thing. Ibn Jarir said, "Allah only said 'Aliyyan (loftiness, exalted)

because all of the religions commend them and mention them with praises, may Allah's peace and blessing be upon them all."12' Jx jt £2; :M te& a* ar k j *4fcr* w /0 , T „ ^51. And mention in the Book, Musa. Verily, he was Mukhlisan and he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.} 452. And We called him from the right side of the Mount (Tiir), and made him draw near to Us for a talk with him.} 453. And We granted him his brother Harun, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy.} Mentioning Musa and Harun After Allah had mentioned Ibrahim, the Friend of Allah, aiid commended him, he next mentioned Al-Kalim (the one spoken to by Allah directly). Allah said, iAnd mention in the Book, Musa. Verily, he was Mukhlisan} Ath-Thawri reported from 'Abdul-Aziz bin Rafi', from Alsu Lubabah that he said, "The Disciples (of Isa) said, 'O Spirit of Allah, inform us about the one who is Mukhlis (purely devoted) to Allah.' He said, That is one who does a deed solely for Allah and he does not like for the people to praise him.' " Others recited the word as Mukhlas, which means that he was chosen. This is as Allah says, j[} 4 Verily, I have chosen you above men.} [7:144] Concerning Allah's statement, At-Tabari 18:208. At-Tabari 18:208.

iatid he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet. Allah combined these two descriptions for him. For verily, he was one of the greatest Messengers and one of the five Messengers of Strong Will. They are NOh, Ibrahim, Musa, Isa and Muhammad. May the blessings of Allah be upon them and all of the Prophets. Allah said, s-C Jt iAnd We called him from the side of the Ti/r> means Mount irect} It was on the right side ofMusa when he went seeking a burningwood from that fire. He saw its glow in the distance, so he set out towards it and found it on the right side of the mountain from his direction, at the edge of the valley that he was in. This is when Allah, the Exalted, spoke to him and called out to him. Allah summoned him to come near and He conversed Ayah with him. Concerning His statement, / , S / 1 j' * \ 4And We granted him his brother Hariin, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy This means, "We responded to his request and his plea on behalf of his brother and We made him a Prophet as well." This is as Allah says in another Ayah, cJ SO 6l y, y iAnd my brother Hariin he is more eloquent in speech than me: so send him with me as a helper to confirm me. Verily, I fear that they will belie me .^ [28:34] Also, Allah said, 4 »*![]» 4(Allah said:) "You are granted your request, O Musa."} [20:36] He also said,

c5ia cs\$# 4So se;uf /or Harfm. And they have a charge of crime against me, and Ifear they ivill kill me.} [26:13-14] Because of this, some of the Salaf (predecessors) said, "No one in this life pleaded on behalf of someone else more than Musa pleaded for his brother to be a Prophet." Allah, the Exalted said, 4And We granted him his brother Harm, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy.} ..nit st Vj-y o^j Al 4 'iiJ o&y 'iPifj 454. And mention in the Book, Ismd'tl. Verily, he was true to what he promised, and he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.} 455. And he would enjoin on his family and his people the Saldh and the Zakdh, and his Lord was pleased with him.} Mentioning Isma'fl Here Allah has commended Ismail, the son of Ibrahim, the Friend of Allah. He (Ismail) is the father of all of the Arabs of the Hijaz because he was true to what he promised. Ibn Jurayj said, "He did not make any promise to his Lord, except that he fulfilled it." He never obligated himself to do any act of worship with a vow, except that he fulfilled it and carried it out, giving it its full due. Some said, 5>£>} 4(he was) true to what he promised.} "This was said about him because he said to his father, 4 0} Jit 41fAllah wills you willfind me of the patient.} [37:102] So he was truthful in that." Being true to one's promise is one m At-Tabari 18 :2 1 1

of the praiseworthy characteristics, just as breaking one's promise is of the detested characteristics. Allah, the Exalted, says, *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ إِنَّكَم مِّنَ الصَّادِقِينَ* [61:2-3] The Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* said, *لِلْجُنَّةِ ثَلَاثٌ: إِذَا تَكَلَّمَ كَذَبَ، إِذَا وَعَدَ خَانَ، وَإِذَا أُتْرِفَ بَخِلَ* «The sign of the hypocrite is three things. When he speaks, he lies; when he promises, he breaks his promise; and when he is entrusted with something, he is disloyal to his trust. Thus, if these are the characteristics of the hypocrites, then behaving contrary to these is a characteristic of the true believer. For this reason, Allah commended His servant and Messenger Ismail, for he was true to his promise. Likewise, the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* was true to his promise. He did not promise anyone anything, except that he fulfilled his promise to that person. He also commended Abu Al-'As bin Ar-Rabi', the husband of his daughter Zaynab, by saying, *«يَا جَابِرُ إِذَا تَكَلَّمَ بَلَغَ الْحَقَّ، وَإِذَا وَعَدَ بَلَغَ الْوَعْدَ، وَإِذَا أُتْرِفَ بَلَغَ الْوَفَاءَ*» «He spoke to me and he told me the truth, and he promised me and he fulfilled his promise to me.» When the Prophet *ﷺ* died, the Khalifah (his successor), Abu Bakr As-Siddiq said, "Whoever received any promise from the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* or was owed any debt by him, then let him come to me and I will fulfill it on his behalf." So Jabir bin 'Abdullah came and related that the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* said, *«إِذَا جَاءَ الْغَنَاءُ فَخُذْهُ* (to me), then I would give you such and such and such.» Al-Bukhari no.33,2682,2749 ,6095 121 FathAl-Bari 5:380.

This meant that he would fill his hands with wealth. Therefore, when the wealth of Bahrain came (to them), Abu Bakr commanded Jabir to come and fill his hands from that wealth. Then, he commanded him to do so again, until he collected five hundred Dirhams. Then, Abu Bakr gave him its double along with it. (i.e. one thousand extra Dirhams). Concerning Allah's statement, *وَأَنذَرْتُكَ أَن تَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَٰؤُلَاءِ* (and) he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.} In this is a proof of Ismail's favored status over his brother, Ishaq. Ishaq was only described as being a Prophet, but Isma'il was described with both prophethood and messengership. It is confirmed in Sahih Muslim that the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* said, *«يَا إِسْمَاعِيلُ إِنَّكَ أَهْلُ الْبَيْتِ وَأَنْتَ خَيْرُهُمْ* » «Verily, Allah chose Isma'il from the sons of Ibrahim. » Then, Imam Muslim mentions the rest of the Hadith in its entirety. However, this statement proves the correctness of what we have said. Allah said. *وَأَنذَرْتُكَ أَن تَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَٰؤُلَاءِ* (and) he would enjoin on his family and his people the Saldh and the Zakat, and his Lord was pleased with him.} This is also a beautiful form of praise, a commendable quality, and an upright characteristic. He was commanded in this way because of his persistence in obedience of his Lord, and enjoining his family to do so. This is as Allah said to His Messenger *ﷺ*, *وَأَنذَرْتُكَ أَن تَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَٰؤُلَاءِ* (and) enjoin the Saldh on your family, and be patient with them.} [20:132] Also, Allah, the Exalted, said, *وَأَنذَرْتُكَ أَن تَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَٰؤُلَاءِ* 121 FathAl-Bari 4:554. 121 Muslim 4:1782.

—*يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ إِنَّكَم مِّنَ الصَّادِقِينَ* —*يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ إِنَّكَم مِّنَ الصَّادِقِينَ* ; *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ إِنَّكَم مِّنَ الصَّادِقِينَ* W 4jl Oj^2Jki iO you who believe! Protect yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell) whose fuel is men and stones, over which are (appointed) angels stern (and) severe, who disobey not, (from executing) the commands they receive from Allah, but do that which they are commanded.} [66:6] This means to command them to do good, forbid them from evil and do not neglect them. If you do so, and they obey your command, the Fire (of Hell) will not devour them on the Day of Resurrection. It has been reported in a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah *ﷺ* said, *«يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ إِنَّكَم مِّنَ الصَّادِقِينَ* » «May Allah have mercy upon a man who gets up at night to pray and he wakes his wife. If she refuses to get up, he sprinkles water in her face. May Allah have mercy upon a woman who gets up at night to pray and she wakes her husband. If she refuses to get up, she sprinkles

water in his face. This Hadith was recorded by Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah. 1 ' 1 156. And mention in the Book, Idris. Verily, he was a man of truth, (and) a Prophet. 157. And We raised him to a high station.} Mentioning Idris Allah complimented Idris for being a truthful Prophet and He mentioned that he raised him to a high station. It has previously been mentioned that in the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah passed by Idns on the night of the Isra (Night Journey) and he (Idris) was in the fourth heaven. I 1 Abu Dawud 2 :73, Ibn Majah 1 :424.

Jr r*T Sufyan reported from y"S"4' / / >/ ^ -J > ^ >*** ,, Cfl b-iy> jcxo\$ gj j»jLijj^ \$h&sj&+\$t oyjL>^tjCjJAjJ_>c;Cj gx^Czol^li^ ^ liJ> uty) ^aLCj&j\$ Mansur that Mujah^d said, i&fy Cfc to4And We raised him a high station .> “This means the fourth heaven.”* 11 Al-Hasan and others said concerning Allah’s statement, 4;1& t&&&> to4And We raised him a high station . “This means Paradise.” J* ii' bll>- fj» iiji j \ v-r -• r-i -*t - * U uiv-Jj (c£>f, tsjj la> gy If ft* 3* *H ^-5*r-i> l?-4* a4y <£L \)% cp~\$ ck itt4 458. Those were they unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam, and of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Niih, and of the offspring of Ibrahim and Israel, and from among those whom We guided and chose. When the Ayat of the Most Gracious were recited unto them, they fell down prostrate and weeping. These Prophets are the Chosen Ones Allah, the Exalted, says that these Prophets (were favored), tjut this does not mean only these Prophets who were mentioned in this Surah. Rather, it is referring to all of those who were m At-Tabari 18 :213

Prophets. Allah merely changes the implication of the discussion from specific individuals to the entire group of Prophets. Ji y «»' j*"1 qy»ip ithey unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam.} As-Suddi and Ibn Jarir both said, “That which is meant by the offspring of Adam is Idris, and what is meant by the offspring of those ‘whom We carried with Nuh’ is Ibrahim, and what is meant by the offspring of Ibrahim is Ishaq, Ya'qflb and IsmaH, and what is meant by the offspring of Israll is Musa, Harun, Zakariyya, Yayha and Isa bin Maryam.” Ibn Jarir said, “And that is the distinction of their genealogies, even though Adam gathers all of them (as their original father). This is because among them is he who was not a descendant of those who were on the ship with Nuh, and he that is Idris. For verily, he was the grandfather of Nuh.” I say that this is the most apparent meaning, which concludes that Idris is amongst the pillars of Nuh’s ancestral lineage. The view that this Ayah refers to the ancestral lineage of the Prophets, is the fact that it is similar to Allah’s statement in Surah Al-An‘am, >\$ ~!-Vj jj. y o?J ot j ^ l-- ; fejj j\f’ •*?? ^ <>>' s K* 'SS\>' 'VujAj *>j\ a U»jb y*yj y J1 rrii*3 oij 3* bLjii iAnd that was our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We raise whom We will in degrees. Certainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing. And We bestowed upon him Isliq and Ya'qub, each of them We guided ; and before him We guided Nuh, and among his progeny Dawiid, Sulayman, 111 At-Tabari 18:214.

Ayyub, Yusuf, Musa and Hdriin. Thus do We reivard the doers of good. And Zakariyya, and Yahya, and Tsd and Ilyas, each one of them was of the righteous. And Isma'il and Al- Yasd' and Yunus and Lilt and each one of them We preferred above the ‘Alamin. And also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethem, We chose them, and We guided them to the straight path.>[6:83-87] Until Allah’s statement, iThey are those whom Allah had guided. So follow their guidance.) [6:90] Allah, the Exalted, says, inside p (A -djC O 40f some of them We have related to you their story. And of some We have not

related to you their story.) [40:78] In Sahih Al-Bukhari it is reported from Mujahid that he asked Ibn ‘Abbas, “Is there a prostration in Surah Sad?” Ibn ‘Abbas replied, “Yes.” Then he recited, *ilii cjjJ* iThey are those whom Allah had guided. So folloiv their guidance.) [6:90] Ibn ‘Abbas then said, “So your Prophet is one of those who have been commanded to follow them. And he is of those who should be followed.” - referring to Dawud. Allah, the Exalted, said in this noble Ayah, *4&j p£* iWhen the Ayah of the Most Gracious were recited unto them, I they fell down prostrate and weeping This means that when they heard the Words of Allih, (i) Fath Al-Bari 8:14. The reference is to Ayah no. 24 of Sad (38) where it is mentioned that DawQd , peace be upon him prostrated Since Allah ordered following what they were guided to in thlese Ayat of Al-An'am, then we should also prostrate at the mention of the Prophets prostrations , according to Ibn ‘Abbas

282 TafsJr Ibn Kathir mentioning His proofs and evidences, they prostrated to their Lord in humility, humbleness, praise and thanks for the great favors they were blessed with. The word Bukiyan at the end of the Ayah means those who are crying, and it is the plural of BakL Due to this the scholars agree that it is legislated to prostrate upon reading this Ayah, in following them and adhering to their manner of worship. >• UjaL * t jpL,i»l t ib. ijf* ^±x£- 5 s *> / ^ /// < * %y ws / / 1/ / ^ , Sfj aIjL ij^Uvu UiV 459. 77ien, f/iere /ias succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh and havefollmoed lusts. So they will meet Ghaiy . 460. Except those who repent and believe, and work righteousness. Such will enter Paradise and they will not be ivronged in aught . Theywere succeededbyWicked PeopleandGood People After Allah mentioned the party of blessed ones - the Prophets and those who followed them by maintainig the limits set by Allah and His commandments, fulfilling what Allah ordered and avoiding His prohibitions - then He mentions, {there has succeeded them a posterity.) This means later generations. iwho have lost Saldh Losing their prayers is when they do not consider the prayers obligatory. Therefore they lose, because the prayer is the pillar and foundation of the religion. It is the best of the servants’ deeds. Thus, these people will occupy themselves with worldly desires and delights, and they will be pleased with the life of this world. They will be tranquil and at ease in the worldly appetites. Therefore, these people will meet with Ghaiy, which means loss on the Day of Resurrection. Al-Awzal reported from Mtisa bin Sulayman, who reported from Al-Qasim bin Mukhaymirah that he said concerning Allah’s statement,

^ I' y-U.1 ^ ^ iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh> “This means that they will not keep up with the proper times of the prayer, because if it meant complete abandonment of the prayer, this would be disbelief.” 1 11 It is also reported that it was said to Ibn Mas*ud, “Allah often mentions the prayer in the Qur’an. He says, iThose loho neglect their Saldh.} [107:5] And He says, iThose who remain constant in their Saldh.} [70:23] And He says, iWlw guard their Saldh.}” [23:9] Then, Ibn Mas*ud said, “This means at its designated times. The people said, “We thought that this was referring to the abandonment of the prayer.” He replied, “That would be disbelief.”121 Masruq said, “No one who guards the five daiy prayers will be written among the heedless. In their neglect is destruction. Their neglect is delaying them past their fixed times.”131 Al-Awza! reported from Ibrahim bin Zayd that Umar bin ‘Abdul-‘Az!z recited the Ayah, iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh and have folloiued lusts. So they will meet Ghayy.} Then, he said, “Their loss was not their abandonment of the prayers, but it was by not offering them during their proper At-Jabari 18:215. At-Jabari 18:216. At-Jabari 18:216.

and prescribed times.” Allah said, 4So they will meet Ghayy.} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, 4& iSo they will meet Ghayy.} “This means loss.”2 ' Qatadah said, “This means evil.”3' Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Shu‘bah and Muhammad bin Ishaq all reported from Abu Ishaq As-Sabl, who reported from Abu TJaydah, who reported from ‘Abdullah bin MasMd that he said, 4Li* Cijfc iSo they will meet Ghayy “This is a valley in the Hellfire which is very deep and its food is filthy.”14 ' Al-A‘mash reported from Ziyad, who reported from Abu lyad, who commented Allah’s statement, 4So they will meet Ghayy. He said, “This is a valley in Hell made of puss and blood.” Allah said, <>*** Cl" 4Except those who repent and believe and work righteousness This means, “Except those who recant from giving up the prayers and following the desires, for verily, Allah will accept their repentance, give them a good end and make them of those who inherit the Garden of Delight (Paradise).” For this reason Allah says, 111 At-Tabifii 18:21%. 121 At-Tabari :21\$. 131 At-TabaM . At-Tabari 18:2T&.

285Surah 19. Maruam (61-63) (Part-16) 4Such will enter Paradise and they will not be wronged in aught.) This is because repentance wipes away that which was before it. In another Hadith, the Prophet jg said, •Si vJiJi *The one who repents from sin is like he who has no sin.» l 11 Because of this, those who repent will not lose anything from the (good) deeds that they did. They will not be he^d accountable for what they did before their repentance, thus causing a decrease in their reward for deeds that they do after their repentance. That is because whatever they did before repenting is lost, forgotten and not taken to account. This is an honor from the Most Generous and a kindness from the Most Gentle. This is an exception that is made for these people, similar to Allah’s statement in Surah Al-Furqan, 4And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause...) until Allah’s statement, iatid Allah is Oft-Forgiving, , # fe v 0k. x& Uit ja* \$& ±Z) <04x » ^\$xl (They will enter) 'Adn Gardens which the Most Gracious has promised to His servants in the unseen. Verily, His promise must come to pass.) They shall not hear therein any Laghw, but only Salam. And they will have therein their sustenance, morning and afternoon.) Such is the Paradise which We shall give as an inheritance to those ofOur servants who had Taqwa.) Ibn Majah 2 :1420.

286 TafsTr Ibn Kathir

The Description of the Gardens of the Truthful and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3451–3454]

ThoseWho repent Allah, the Exalted, says that the Gardens (of Paradise), which the penitent will enter, will be Gardens of ‘Adn, meaning, eternity. These are Gardens that the Most Beneficent promises His servants in the unseen. This means that these Gardens are from the unseen things that they believe in, even though they have never witnessed them. They believe in the unseen out of their strong conviction and the strength of their faith. Concerning Allah’s statement, 4&U Jit iVerily, His promise must come to pass.} This affirms the fact that this will occur, and that it is a settled matter. Allah does not break His promise, nor does He change it. This is similar to His statement, iHis promise is certainly to be accomplished.} [73:18) This means that His promise will be and there is no avoiding it. Allah’s statement here, imust come to pass.} This means that it will come to His servants who are striving

towards it and they will reach it. There are those commentators who said, *innst come to pass.*} “This means it is coming, because everything that comes to you, you also come to it. This is as the Arabs say, ‘Fifty years came to me, and I came to fifty years.’ They both mean the same thing (I’m fifty years old).” Concerning Allah’s statement, *OjICj v} iThey shall not hear therein any Laghio.*} This means that in these gardens of Paradise there is no ignorant, wasteful and useless speech, like there is in this life. He said,

287 Surah 19. Man/am (61-63) (Part-16) 4...but only Salam This Allah’s statement, *vi^* is an indifferent exception, similar *i liL Mi VI % £j£ v> 4*No Laghw will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: Salam! Salam!) [56:25-26] Concerning His statement, *4*And they will have therein their sustenance , morning and afternoon This means, in what is similar to mornings and evenings. This does not mean that there is a night and a day (in Paradise), but they will be living in times that alternate. They will know its lighted times from its lights and illumination. This is as Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah, who said that *tlje* Messenger of Allah said, *^J 4 ^ a'j*j Jji p*jì**J . L#-i j_vk JJ J* ijliy’jj j&j J-lJl A‘jN\ ‘prb Jfc-I V tjJLAil y> jvAiJl* ‘The first group to enter into Paradise will have forms like the form of the moon on a night when it is full. They *ivill* not spit, nor will they blow their noses therein. They also will not defecate. Their containers and combs *ivill* be made of gold and silver and their censers will be of aloeswood. Their sweat will be the fragrance of musk and each of them will have two wives . The marrow of their shins will be visible from beneath the skin due to their beauty. They *ivill* not have any disputes between them, or any hatred. Their hearts will be united like the heart of one man. They will glorify Allah in the morning and evening . [1] m Ahmad 2 :316.

289 Surah 19. Man/am (64-65) (Part-16) Firdaws. In it they shall dwell forever.} [23:10-11] *iA!j o& Uj jJi’i Uj UIU- Uj Cjji U /J iiljj jXt JjAii l’j.f}* 4 A Ji -fixA i-i-eli Uj Jfijij Cij ^ I 464. And we descend not except by the command of your Lord. To Him belongs what is before us and what is behind us, and

what is between those two; and your Lord is never forgetful.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3454]

465. Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, so worship Him and abide patiently in His worship. Do you know of any who is similar to Him?} The Angels do not descend, except by Allah’s Command Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said to Jibril, *a*What prevents you from visiting us more than you do?» Then this Ayah was revealed, *_j*^*, *4*And we descend not except by the command of your Lord.*^• 1*| Al-Bukhari was alone in recording it and he related it with the

Tafsir of this Ayah.[2] Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3454–3478]

he said, “Jibril was kept from visiting the Messenger of Allah 3b, SO he was disturbed and grieved because of this. Then, Jibril came to him and said, ‘O Muhammad, *’Il ^j}* *4*And we descend not except by the command of your Lord.}’ ”<3 I Allah said, U A} j (3J Ahmad 1 :231 Fath Al-Bari 8 :282 At-Tabari 18:222. This is also reported by others from Ibn ‘Abbas. See the previous reference

\$To Him belongs what is before us and what is behind us,} It has been said that the meaning of “what is before us” refers to that which is in this life and “what is behind us” refers to the Hereafter. iand zuhat is between those txoo;} This means what is between two blows of the Sur. This is the opinion of Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Ikrimah and Mujahid. This was also stated by Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah in one narration from them. As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas¹¹¹ held this opinion as well. It has also been said, iCJ 'JZ iwhat is before its} means the future matters of the Hereafter. iGl iivhat is behind us,} means what has taken place in this life, M Cj} iwhat is between those two;} means what happens between this life and the Hereafter. A statement like this explanation has been reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and Ath-Thawri.¹²¹ Ibn Jarir also preferred this latter interpretation. And Allah knows best. Concerning Allah’s statement, i~> <4>j iand your Lord is neverforgetful,}^ Mujahid said, “This means thatyour Lord has not forgotten you.” Allah said, iLord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them,} At-Tabari 18:224. ^ At-Tabari 18:224, Al-Qurtubi 11 : 129 At-Tabari 18:225.

J r\ . mm» - I,yUiL«j rJ'oj La— ,AJ_iCoJi &s 01.gd «i^4i - " J •" •- .«..><?«; c*f' ,i.- -- >{* **&», :v*"»l*2->i<j'JU', 2^i e- jvy L—iA<l>~.>- He created all of that, He is the Disposer of its affairs, He is the Legi- slator over it and He is in absolute control of ijt, having no one to oppose His decisions. ji . *xJ J&Z&j i-^xj^ 4^ i iso worship Him add abide patiently in his ivorship. Do you knmv of any zolio is similar to Him?} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abb3s said that this means, “Do you know any comparison or some- thing similar to the Lord?”¹¹¹ Mujahid, Sa‘Id bin Jubayr, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and others all said the same.¹²¹ ‘Ikrimah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “There is no oje named Ar-Rahman (the Most Beneficent) other than Him, Blessed and Exalted is He. Most Holy is His Name.”³ S? ot i-ii- £i ^=>j; Vji " £>.1 J>jJ d-i C 'i.l Sfvi'j} / " . '{<" ••'t" •*: ' I ' /i*" • .. ./ -> >' sOf/J ^4“*^ 4>*“ >-» O^kyJlj pfj/s-aO 4 ir, <2\$ ^ ?v6* J* ii3 jT 0# <(66. Anrf man sai/s: "kWien / am dead, shall 1 then be raised up alive?"} ^0—4?^ La»- ^ l£Jla)jJC-a' flp '3 G' Olirili) ' }j At-Tabari 18:226. At-Tabari 18:226. [31 Al-Qurtubi 11 :130

Gf 24 gSap It cUj4 .ji' iAnd matt says: “When I am dead, shall I then be raised up alive?” Does not man remember that We created him before, while he was nothing?} Allah uses the beginning of creation as a proof for its repetition. This means that He, the Exalted, created tljie human being while he was nothing. So can he not repeat this creation after the human had actually become something? Similaliy Allah says; /i' , > Ci'Tn ..If ""V n. • _y f IjXf, lSAH iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easierfor Him.} [30:27] In the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah sg said, fST j;l ^1i\j pj fjTp ^jS :,JU; &l JyiA ipJl Jjl J-lJj US' jJ Jjai ijt\ 4-jiSj Ul ji <J ^JJI Iwill Jli-Sll IjJj IjJj ^ jl *ijji J;l5| «bt Utj fc ^jA j^aL Uif \$k 2 JJj^ fJj jo; (U uAllah, the Exalted said, "The son ofAdam denies Me and he has no right to deny Me. The son ofAdam harms Me and he has no right to harm Me. His denial ofMe is his statement that I will never repeat His creation like I created him the first time. Yet, the second creation is not more difficult upon Me than the first. His harming Me is his statement that I have a son. Yet, I am One Alone, the Self-Sufficient Whom all creatures need. He Who does not beget children, nor was He bom and there is none coequal or comparable unto Him."®¹¹¹ Concerning Allah’s statement, ik iSo by your Lord, surely We shall gather them together, and IM Ahmad 2 :350

the Shayiitin,} The Lord, Blessed be He the Most High, swears by His Noble Self that He will definitely gather all of those who worshipped other than Allah and their devils as well. 4^ f'-**!' - Hrlr^d ithen We shall bring them round Hell, Jithiyya.} Al-'Awfi related that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means sitting and it is similar to His statement, iAnd you will see each nation Jathiyah .^ 1| " [45:28] As-Suddi commented on the word Jithiyya, "It means standing." It has been reported from Murrah that Ibn Mas*ud said the same. Concerning Allah's statement, 4&~£m ft iThen indeed We shall drag outfrom every sect This means from every nation. This is what Mujahid said.*21 iall those who were worst in obstinate rebellion against the Most Gracious.} Ath-Thawrl reported from 'Ali bin Al-Aqmar, from Abu Al- Ahwas, from Ibn Mas'ud that he said, "The first of them will be bound to the last of them until their number is complete. Then, they will be brought all together. Then, Allah will begin with the greatest of them in crime and continue in succession. That is Allah's statement, 4 cpy & y oi "f} iThen indeed We shall drag out from every sect all those zoho 111 At-Tabari 18:227. At-Tabari 18:228.

were worst in obstinate rebellion against the Most Gracious.^ This is similar to Allah's statement, UZja Cije. Cj JjU 4Until they will be gathered all together in the Fire. The last of them ivill say to the first of them : "Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire."} Until His saying, iFor what you used to earn.} [7:38-39] The first of them will say to the last of them: "Your were not better than us, so taste the torment forwhatyou used to earn. Concerning Allah's statement, 4' v;'.&r? ^ jU os|v f} iThen, verily, We know best those ivho are most toorthy of being burnt therein.} Then, at this point Allah attaches one piece of information to another. The meaning here is that Allah best knows which of His creatures deserve to be burned in the fire of Hell and remain there forever and who deserves to have his punishment doubled. This is as He says in the Ayah that was previous y mentioned, i'opl V p, ti} 4He ivill say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you knoiv not."} [7:38] CjSvjiii! jjl j f v' , UijL ^ "5/] u!. 4:Vr £ 471. There is not one ofyou but will pass over it (Hell); this is with your Lord, a decree which must be accomplished.} 472. Then We shall save those who had Taqwa. And We shall leave the ivrongdoers in it, Jithiyya.} Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :533

' j'i «L»J V) jdll is! is! «No one of the Muslims who has had three children, zuho all died, will be touched by the Hellfire, except for an oath that must be fidfilled .s' 1 ' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah's statement, VI j&i iThere is not one ofyou but will pass over it;} "The passing of the Muslims (over the Hellfire) means their passing over a bridge that is over it. But the passing of the idolaters over the Hellfire refers to their admission to the Fire." As-Suddi reported from Murrah, from Ibn Mas*ud, that he said concerning Allah's statement, lsi- isfij&&} ithis is with your Lord; a Hatman decree.} "An oath that must be fulfilled."121 Mujahid said, "Hatman means preordainment."*3 ' Ibn Jurayj said the same.14 ' Concerning Allah's statement, ojj!' ff iThen We shall save those who had Taqwd.} When all of the creatures passed over the Hellfire, and those disbelievers and the disobedient people who are destined to fall into it because of their disobedience, Allah will save the believers and the righteous people from it because of their deeds. Therefore, their passing over the bridge and their speed will be based upon their deeds that they did in this life. Then, the believers who performed major sins will be allowed intercession. The angels, the Prophets and the believers will all intercede. Thus, a large number of the sinners will be allowed to come out of Hell. The fire will have devoured much of their Fath Al-Bari 3 : 142 , Muslim 4 :2028 121 At-Tabari 18:237. 131 At-Tabari 18:237. 141 At-Tabari 18:237.

298 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir bodies, except the places of prostration on their faces. Their removal from the Hellfire will be due to the faith in their hearts. The first to come out will be he who has the weight of a Dinar of faith in his heart. Then, whoever has the next least amount after him. Then, whoever is next to that after him, and so forth. This will continue until the one who has the tiniest hint of faith in his heart, equal to the weight of an atom. Then, Allah will take out of the Fire whoever said “La ilaha illalldh,” even one day of his entire life, even if he never performed any good deed. After this, no one will remain in the Hellfire, except those it is obligatory upon to remain in the Hellfire forever. This has been reported in many authentic Hadiths from the Messenger of Allah. This is why Allah says, ^ v" 'On 'tj jjjj iThen We shall save those who had Taqwd. And We shall leave the wrongdoers in it, Jithyya. > |1) UJL* j±- c/j JU ^ j|} Oi 473. And when Our clear Ayat are recited to them, those who disbelieve say to those who believe: “Which of the two groups has the best dwellings and the finest Nadiyyan?” > 474. And how many a generation have We destroyed before them, wlv were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} The Disbelievers boast over Their good Fortune in the World Allah, the Exalted, informs that when the clear, evident Ayat of Allah are recited to the disbelievers, they reject them and turn away. They say about those who believe, while boasting to them and arguing that their false religion is correct, ibest dwellings and the finest Nadiyyan. [i] Fath Al-Bari 13:48.

299 Surah 19. Man/am (73-74) (Part-16) This means the best houses, with the loftiest levels and the finest Nadiyyan, which are meeting rooms for men to gather and discuss matters. Thus, this means that their meeting rooms are full of more people who come to attend. In this they were saying, “How can we be upon falsehood while we are in this manner of successful living?” These people were actually those who were concealed in the house of Al-Arqam bin Abi Al-Arqam and its likes from the other houses. This is as Allah says about them, iAnd those who disbelieve said of those who believe: "Had it been a good thing, they (the weak and the poor) would not have preceded us thereto!" [46:11] Nuh's people said, 4 ™!opSjV' &\$} i"Shall we believe in you, when the weakest (of the people) follow you?" [26:111] And Allah says, £2 iThus Wc have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) whom Allah has favored among us?" Does not Allah know best those who are grateful?} [6:53] This is why Allah refuted their doubts: It 4h iAnd how many a generations have We destroyed before them} This means, “How many nations and generations did jWe destroy of those who denied (this message) due to their disbelief?” iwho were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} This means that they were better than these present people in wealth, possessions, looks and appearance. Al-A'mash reported from Abu Zibyan, who reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said concerning the Ayah,

dwellings and finest Nadiyyan.) “Position [Maqam] means home, Nadi means place of gathering, wealth refers to material possessions and outward appearance is how they look physically.” 111 Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, “Position [Afaqam] means dwelling, Nadi means place of gathering and the blessing and happiness that they were living in. This is as Allah says about the people of Fir'awn when He destroyed them and related the story of their situation in the Qur'an, its!&& iHow many gardens and springs that they [Fir'awn's people] left behind, and green crops and honored places [Maqam] .) (44:25-26) Therefore, position [Afaqdm] refers to their dwellings and splendid bounties, and Nadi is the places of gathering and meeting where they used to congregate. Allah said while relating the story to His Messenger jg of what happened with the people of Lut, iAnd practice Al-Munkar (evil deeds) in

your meeting places [Nadiyahum].) [29:29] The Arabs call a place of gathering a Nadl'W 475. Say: whoever is in error, the Most Gracious will extend [circumstances] for him, until, when they see that which they were promised, either the torment or the Hour, they will come to know who is worst in position, and who is weaker in forces.) At-Tabari 18:239,241. At-Tabari 18:239.

301 Surah 19. Maryam (73-75) (Part-16 The Rebellious Person is given Respite but He is not forgotten Allah, the Exalted, says, 4 Say} This means, "O Muhammad, say to these people who are associating partners with their Lord, while claiming to follow the truth, that they are really following falsehood." 4 whoever is in error This means, *be they from us or from you.' 4 & 4 the Most Gracious will extend [circumstances] for him> This means that the Most Beneficent will give him respite in that which he is in, until he meets his Lord and his appointed time will have arrived. <\$4>UuJ' iiL; 'ij 4 until, when they see that which they were promised, either the torment} that will strike him, ll t0 4 or the Hour that will come suddenly, 4 they will come to know} at that time. 4 who is worst in position, and who is weaker in forces.} This is in refutation of their argument about their nice dwellings and splendid places of gathering. This is a challenge against the idolators who claim that they were following guidance in what they were doing. This is similar to the challenge that Allah mentions about the Jews when He says, r 4 3 SI !££ & * A p -pj o> £6 (\$&

302 Tafslr Ibn Katfur 40 you Jews! If you pretend that you are friends of Allah, to the exclusion of (all) other people, then long for death if you are truthful.} [62:6] Meaning, 'Supplicate for death to come to those who are following falsehood among us if you truly claim to be upon the truth. If you are true, then this supplication will not harm you.' But they refused to do so. An extensive discussion of this has already preceded in Surat Al-Baqarah, and to Allah is the praise. Likewise, Allah mentioned the challenge that was given to the Christians in Surah Al 'Imrdn,[1] when they were persistent in their disbelief and continued in their transgression. They refused to give up their exaggerating claim that 'Isa was the son of Allah. Therefore, Allah mentioned His arguments and proofs against the worship of 'Isa, and that he was merely a creature like Adam. After this, Allah said, 'jhj jii j* AOi. d sp2 ^ jto; iThen whoever disputes with you about him after (all this) knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let 11s call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves - then we pray and invoke (sincerely) the curse of Allah upon those who lie."} [3:61] However, they (the Christians) also retreated from this challenge. 4 ^ ~J Cly bt, _*i- c. .lfrj j o'JJS \jx~iA iii bfjj} 476. And Allah increases in guidance those ivho walk aright. And the righteous good deeds that last are better with your Lordfor rexoard and betterfor resort.} Increasing Guidance ofThoseWho are guided After Allah mentions the extended time and respite that is allowed to those who are in misguidance, increasing them in misguidance, He informs of the increase in guidance of those who are rightly guided. Similarly He says, For these discussions , see volume one , the Tafslrof SfiratAl-Baqarah (2 :94) ,and volume two , the Tafslrof SurahAl 'Imran (3:61).

^Amf whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them say : "Winch ofyou has had his faith increased by it?"} [9:124] And the following Ayah also shows this. Concerning Allah's statement, 4And the righteous good deeds that last^ Its explanation has already preceded in Surat Al-Kahf along with a lengthy discussion concerning it and the related Hadiths. 4(they) are better with your Lordfor reward.} meaning the recompense and reward. 4v 4and better for resort. meaning in the final outcome, the re for

its doer. suit JCjt AiA f ^\X»l w */U Ja jji: u ^ j>; u 4i&: '-j ^ yJz=> ,va 477. Hooe i/oii seen /i>>> to/10 disbelieved in Our Aydt and said: "I shall certainly be given wealth and children [if I live again]."

478. Has he known the Unseen or has he taken a covenant from the Most Gracious?} 479. Nay, We shall record what he says, and We shall increase his torment;} 480. And We shall inherit from him all that he speaks of, and he shall come to Us alone.} See volume six , the Tafslr of Surat Al-Kahf (18 :46)

304 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Refuting the Disbelievers Who claim that They will be given Wealth and Children in the Hereafter Imam Ahmad reported from Khabbab bin Al-Aratt that he said, "I was a blacksmith and Al-'As bin Wa'il owed me a debt. So I went to him to collect my debt from him. He said to me, 'No, by Allah, I will not pay my debt to you until you disbelieve in Muhammad.' I replied to him, 'No, by Allah, I will not disbelieve in Muhammad until you die and are resurrected again. He then said to me, Verily, if I die and am resurrected, and you come to me, I will also have abundance of wealth and children and I will repay you then.' Then, Allah revealed these Ayat, ft juj ^ iHave you seen him who disbelieved in Our Ayat and said: "/ shall certainly be given wealth and children . "> until, 4'v 1 Ufa iand he shall come to Us alone. This was also recorded by the two compilers of the Sahihs and other collections as well. In the wording of Al-Bukhari it states that Khabbab said, "I used to be a blacksmith in Makkah and I made a sword for Al-'As bin Wa'il. So I went to him to collect my pay from him..." then he mentioned the rest of the Hadlth and he said, Ji it jji ior has he taken a covenant from the Most Gracious?} "This means an agreement."*2 Concerning Allah's statement, iHas he known the Unseen> This is a rejection of the person who says, ft *** Ahmad 5:111. Fath Al-Bari4 :372 , Muslim 4 :2 153

305 Surah 19. Maruam (77-80) (Part-16) 41 shall certainly be given wealth and children. Meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. In other words, "Does he know what he will have in the Hereafter, to such an extent that he can swear to it?" Aii Ji} 4or has he taken a covenant from the Most Gracious?} Or has he received a promise from Allah that he will be given these things? It has already been stated that in Sahih Al- Bukhdri it is mentioned that covenant means an agreement . Concerning Allah's statement, 4Nay,} This is a participle that opposes what came before it and gives emphasis to what follows it. i 4We shall record what he says,} what he is seeking, and his idea that he has given himself about what he hopes for, and his disbelief in Allah the Most Great. y'iii' ck *A 4We shall increase his torment.} This is referring to what will happen in the abode of the Hereafter, because of his saying his disbelief in Allah in this life. <& U&} 4And We shall inherit from him all that he speaks of,} His wealth and children. It means, "We will take all of this from him, in opposition to his claim that he will be given more wealth and children in the Hereafter than he had in this life." To the contrary, in the Hereafter that which he had in this life will be taken from him. This is why Allah says, 4And he shall come to Us alone.} without wealth or children. pr?6 yZ' '*',"3* iyfh *44.* \$ ^ m FathAl-Bari4:273.

-L«i l2j (> Ji«jo "ii tgptf |Ujji tliijl C>t j5 jA^lju> 462 . And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory.} Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and xvill become their adversaries.} 483. See you not that We have sent the Slrayattn against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} 484. So make no haste against them; We only count out to them a (limited) number.} The Idols of the Polytheists will deny Their Worship Allah, the Exalted, informs about the disbelievers who associate partners with their Lord, that they have taken gods besides Allah, so that these gods may be a source of honor and might for them. They think that these gods give them power

and make them victorious. Then, Allah mentions that the matter is not as they claim, and it will not be as they hope. He says, iNay, but they will deny their worship of them,} on the Day of Judgement. 4ti-f oJfj} iand will become their adversaries.} This means that they will be foes in a state other than what they think about these gods. This is similar to Allah's statement. u* t?. di 5*1 V «a' ojj cA; j— iAnd who is more astray than one who calls upon, besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.} (46:5-6) As-Suddi said,

iNay, but they ivill deny their ivorship of them,} "This means their worshipping of the idols."111 Allah said, djftj} iand will become their adversaries for from these gods. As-Suddi said, contrary to what they hoped oJff} iand will become their adversaries.} "They will be in severe opposition and argument." Ad-Dahhak said, iand ivill become their adversaries.} "This means enemies."121 The Power of the Devils over the Disbelievers Concerning Allah's statement, 4 'r '3 ft j. \$} iSee you not that We have sent the Shayatin against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They will lead them astray with temptation. [31 Al-'Awfi said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They will incite them against Muhammad jg and his Companions."141 Qatadah said, "They will harass them and disturb them until they disobey Allah."151 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said, "This is similar to Allah's statement, At-Tabari 18:251. At-Tabari 18:250. At-Tabari 18:251. 141 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :538 At-Tabari 18:252.

'A A o«V»4\$ Jfi& cr«? 0*Jt }And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious, We appoint for him a Shaytdn to be a companion for him.} ll} " [43:36] Concerning Allah's statement, 4lfsfo J2 Gfc iSo make no haste against them; We only count out to them a (limited) number.} This means, "Do not be hasty with the punishment that is going to befall them, O Muhammad." Sm 4I've only count out to them a number.} This means, "We are only delaying them for a fixed appointment whose time is numbered. They are destined for that and there is no escaping the torment of Allah and His exemplary punishment." Allah says, iAnd consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do.} [14:42] And He says, 4So give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them for a while.} [86:17] And Allah says, 4tLi[iS'/*) 'fd£ &[] 4We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfidness.} [3:178] 4iX •— 31 jr XU ^IJ} At-Tabari 18:252.

^ rn vs.4We let them enjoy for a Mite while, then in the Ilf , . •tfr. **« <4^ ^ to (enter) a great >>', A\$t*.s., .'it' \ torment.} [31:24] lac4u4A3250O«ifc4^ il^ ^^ ikai^ ia5 n' . .XX4 .1ST* JWfl- .It " . - -t "En)°yl But o^xj' J uL*Ju'^^i i vgj certainly, your destina- O^3S&C^,fcS*0\$3& to" is ,fe <Hell> Fire "> vgl As-Suddi said, ^ 4'4^ 4We only count out to thei \ "*" J~T ^ - " f - number.} means years, months, days and oiO 0 ,.< f , . ,r ,A ft :^Sft © ® 4 \ iiOif sfcs v 4 !>y^lii*^r4'4 -*£' 435. The Day We shall gather tlthose with Taqwa unto the Most Gracious (Allah), like a delegation.} 436. And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a thirsty state.} 437. None shall have the power of intercession, but such a one as has received permission (or promise) from the Most Gracious (Allah).} The Condition of the Righteous and the Criminals on the Day of Resurrection Allah, the Exalted, informs about His righteous friends, who feared Him in the life of this world. They followed His

310 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Messengers and believed in what the Messengers told them. They obeyed them in what they commanded them and abstained from that which they prohibited. Allah explains that He will gather these people on the Day of Resurrection like a delegation that has come to Him. A Wafd (delegation) is a group that arrives while riding and from it comes the word Wufud. (arriving). They will come riding upon noble steeds of light from the riding animals of the Hereafter. They will arrive before the Best Receiver of delegations at the abode of His honor and pleasure. In reference to the criminals, who denied the Messengers and opposed them, they will be driven violently to the Hellfire. Allah says, in a thirsty state.} This means parched and thirsting for drink. This was stated by ‘Ata’, Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and many others. Here it will be said, iWhich of the hvo groups is best in Maqant (position) and the finest Nadiyyan (meeting place).}\19:73] Ibn Abi Hatim reported from ‘Amr bin Qays Al-Mulal, who reported from Ibn Marzuq that he said, iThe Day We shall gather those ivith Taqiva unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation.} “When the believer comes forth from his grave, he will meet the most handsome form he has ever seen and it will have the nicest fragrance. He will say, “Who are you?’ The being will reply, “You do not know me?’ The believer will say, ‘No, but Allah has made you sweet smelling with a handsome face.’ The being will say, “I am your righteous deeds. This is how you use to beautify and apply fragrance to your deeds in the worldly life. I was riding upon you in the entire length of your worldly life, so will you not ride upon me now?’ So the believer will therefore mount the creature. This is the meaning of Allah’s statement, At-Tabari 18 :253 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :541

iThe Day We shall gather those with Taqwd unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation .}” ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4The Day We shall gather those with Taqwa unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation. “Riding.”111 His saying, 4And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a thirsty state.} This means parched and thirsty. 4None shall have the power of intercession,} There will be no one who can intercede for them like the believers who intercede for each other. Allah says about them, HiQ }Noto we have no intercessors, nor a close friend.} [26:100- 101] Allah said, 4but such a one as has received permission (or promise) from the Most Gracious.} This is a separate exclusion, which means, “But those who have taken a covenant with the Most Beneficent.” This covenant is the testimony that none has the right to jbe worshipped but Allah, and upholding of its rights and implications. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4i+i 1' X*& ^ 4but such a one as has received permission (or promise) from the Most Gracious At-Tabari 8 :380

312 Tafsir Ibt Kathir “The promise is the testimony that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah, that the person accepts that all power and strength belong to Allah and he only places his hope with Allah alone.” a£j ojJii'j &eL-=C\ jjSi ^ 4 &U s. c\$\$ i# oi a# ^^ \$\$\$ %jm 4^^- 4 tA' 4SS. And they say: "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son."} 489. Indeed you have broughtforth (said) a thing Idda.} i90. Whereby the heavens are almost tom, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda .} 491 . That they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious. 492. But it is not suitable for the Most Gracious that He should beget a son.} 493. There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a slave.} 494. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting.} 495. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day ofResurrection.} The Stern Rejection ofattributing a Son to Allah After Allah affirms in this noble Surah that ‘Isa was a worshipper and servant of Allah and He mentioned his birth from Maryam without a father, He then begins refuting

those who claim that He has a son. Holy is He and far Exalted is He above such description. Allah says, *Juft OS5I' Jus! ijGj}* 4And they say: "The Most Gracious has begotten a son." iiT At-Jabari 18:257.

313Surah 19. Maryam (88-95) (Part-16) Indeed you have broughtforth) This means, "In this statement of yours." 4a thing Idda.) Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Malik all said, "Terrible." It has been said that it is pronounced Iddan, Addan, and Addan with elongation on the first vowel. All three of these pronunciations are known, but the most popular is the first. Allah said; && \$£ J >\k=t) iWhereby the heavens are almost tom, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda, that they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious .) that is, out of their high esteem for Allah, when they hear this statement of wickedness coming from the Children of Adam.

The reason for this is that these are creatures of Allah and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3478–3481]

they are established upon His Tawhid and the fact that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He has no partners, no peer, no child, no mate and no coequal. Rather, He is th'e One, Self-Sufficient Master, Whom all creatures are in need of. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn 'Abbas said concerning Allah's statement, ij£ J ;\$>& jOS jij IL fvia; iWhereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda, that they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious.) "Verily, the heavens, the earth, the mountains and all creatures - except for humans and Jinns - are frightened by the associating of partners with Allah. Creation will almost cease existing before the association of partners with Allah, due to His Greatness. Just as the idolator does not benefit bjy his good deeds because of associating partners with Allah, we hope that Allah would forgive the sins of those who believed in

315Surah 19. Maryam (88-95) (Part-16) "This is due to its anger on behalf of Allah, the Mighty arid Sublime." 4and the mountains Hadda Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means to be torn down." Sa'id bin Jubayr said, "Haddan means some of it is broken by other parts of it in succession." Imam Ahmad reported from Abu Musa that he said that tljie Messenger of Allah jg said, '-rij d At 4»| <i)l JA (Jil Ji • Pi\ 9*' » >'r {Jr "There is no one more patient than Allah concerning something harmful that he hears. For verily, partners are associated with Him and a son is ascribed to Him, ivhile He is the One Who gives them good health, protects them and sustains them.i>[li This narration is also recorded in the Two Sahths. In oiie wording of it he said, „ * • I *' * Pt* r * A * t C • * 9 + 9 P*| “ . . .that they attribute a son to Him, while He is the One Who sustains them and gives them good health.^ Allah said; v / iBut it is not suitable for the Most Gracious that He should beget a son.} Meaning that it is not befitting of Him, nor is it appropriate for His lofty majesty and greatness. There is no coequal for Him in His creation, because all creatures are His slaves. This is why He says, Ahmad 4:405. 121 Fath Al-Bari 10 :527 , Muslim 4 :2160

iThere is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a slave. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them afull counting.} He knows their number from the time He created them, until

the Day of Resurrection, male and female, both the small and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3481–3484]

the large of them. iAnd everyone of than will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .} This means that there will be no helper for him and no one to save him, except Allah alone, Who has no partners. He judges His creatures as He wills and He is the Most Just, Who does not do even an atom's weight of injustice. He will not wrong anyone. UiU 1^1. v'-jjjl fit J4 &3jS 'fij S-0, jipss 496. Verily, those who believe and work deeds of righteousness, the Most Gracious will bestow lovefor them.} 497. So, We have made this easy in your own tongue, only that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd, and warn with it the people that are Ludda.} 498. And how many a generation before them have We destroyed! Can you find a single one of than or hear even a whisper of them?} Allah places Love ofthe Righteous People in the Hearts Allah, the Exalted, informs about His believing servants, who work righteous deeds - deeds that He is pleased with because they are in accordance with the legislation ofMuhammad s§ - that He plants love for them in the hearts of His righteous servants. This is something that is absolutely necessary and there is no avoiding it. This has been reported in authentic Hadlths of the Messenger of Allah jg in various different ways. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet 5§g said,

327Surah 19. Man/am (96-98) (Part-16 : Jli U"Ai :Jlii ' jd.pr lii IJup >-~^~t 'M^ Op :JIS U"*i vL->J 2i' 3J jit j? V^4 Ipj I.Lp t lil il jlj ^ Jjjjl <5 ' ;LL^J' J^l SIQ p iJ;J>- *-^?~* JI» U^i t • JI** Jjrr jw jit !-a»7i : jli to^Juuti U^ii «*»' i*! ! »U-Ul Jat ^ a^^iijS/l^ £Lj«J l -J £*>y. '‘Verily, whenever Allah loves a servant of His, He calls Jibril and says, “O fibril, verily I love so-and-so, so love him.” Tims, Jibril will love him. Then, he (Jibril) will call out to the dwellers of the heavens, "Verily, Allah loves so-and-so, so you too must love him." Then the dwellers of the heavens love him and he will be given acceptance in the earth. Whenever Allah hates a servant ofHis, He calls Jibril and says, "O Jibril, verily I hate so-and-so, so hate him." Thus, Jibril will hate him. Then, he (Jibril) will call out amongst the dwellers of the heavens, "Verily, Allah hates so-and-so, so you too must hate him." Then the dwellers of the heavens hate him and hatred for him will be placed in the earth.» ll] Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported narrations similar to this . Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet jg said, Jt lij^~ti ji J\ ' »- t *H' -*J* J 3* J 1 dji ' ^3*2' jit J> vUJl <J Jj! if*zf “Whenever Allah loves a servant of His, He calls Jibril (saying), "Verily, I love so-and-so, so love him." Then, Jibril calls out into the heavens and love for him descends among the people of the earth. That is the meaning of the statement of Allah, the Mighty and Sublime: iVerily, those who believe and work deeds of righteousness, the Most Gracious will bestow love 111 Ahmad 2:413,514. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 1 :476, Muslim 4 :2030

for them . » [19:96] This was also reported by Muslim and At-Tirmidhi and At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahib .”121 The Qur’an descended to give Glad Tidings and to warn Allah said; iSo, We have made this easy} meaning the Qur’an. 4in your own tongue,} This is an address to Prophet Muhammad jg and it means that the Qur’an is in the pure, complete and eloquent Arabic language. 4that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd,} those who respond to Allah and believe in His Messenger sg, iand want with it the people zoho are Ludda.} meaning, the people who have deviated away from the truth and are inclined towards falsehood. His saying, ijj o; (4ft -9f} 4And how many a generation before them have We destroyed!} means from the nations that disbelieved in the signs of Allah and rejected

His Messengers. 4Can you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?'} Meaning, 'have you seen any of them or even heard a whisper 'Abdur-Razzaq 10:450. ^ Muslim 4 : 1031 , Tuhfat Al-Ahuiadhi 8 :608

329Surah 19. Man/am (96-98) (Part-16) from them.' Ibn 'Abbas, Abu Al-'Aliyah, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Alj- Basri, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Zayd all saidj, "This means any sound. Al-Hasan and Qatadah both said that this means, "Do you see with your eye, or hear anv sound?"121

Surah 20: Ta-Ha

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3485]

Opening 320 Tafsir Ibt Kathir The Tafsirof Surah TaHa (Chapter - 20)

Which was revealed at Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3485–3497]

if In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. . j o'tyjf viUc Cijil C uj>jVf 4 Uj 4 ^ /J i f jt jlii &Jr\$y J\$ 'j f\ y , 'yf tfi jyiv oij i) ujil Uj :L:Vt Jj% 41. Ta Ha.} 42. We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} 43. But only as a Reminder to those ivhofear (Allah).} 44. A revelation from Him Wlw created the earth and high heavens.} 45. The Most Gracious Istawd the Throne.} 46. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and all that is between them, and all that is under the soil.} 47. And if you speak aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden.} 48. Allah! There is no God but Him! To Him belong the Best Names.} The Qur'an is a Reminder and a Revelation from Allah We have already discussed the separated letters at the beginning of Surah Al-Baqarah, so there is no need to repeat its discussion here. Allah says, 4i j Jjdc- (jf X.)

<\$We have not sent doivn the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress, Juwaybir reported that Ad-Dahhak said, "When Allah sent the Qur'an down to His Messenger jg, he and his Companions adh- ered to it. Thus, the idolators of the Quraysh said, 'This Qur'an was only reve- aled to Muhammad to cause him distress.' Therefore, Allah revealed, i t'.£ 4Ta Ha. We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress, but only as a Reminder to those whofear (Allah). The matter is not like the people of falsehood claim. Rather, whomever Allah gives knowledge to, it is because Allah wants him to have an abundance of good. This like what is confirmed in the Two Sahihs on the authority of Ibn Mas'ud, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 1Whomever Allah wants good for, then He gives him the understanding of the religion.^ Mujahid commented on Allah's statement, \ '*jk f Asj \ -'j V//'_ / \$ CP'J&A jl« .y: iiUj ' bu><y ^p(X*^ jlii ^ /ff /i^ sJ-aA • Al-Qurtubi 11 :167. 121 Path Al-Bari l :97, Muslim 2:719.

Jii (j)li L\$> 4We have not sent dmvn the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} "This is like His statement, 'jCL U <fSo recite as much of the Qur'an as may be easy (for you).} [73 :20] For, the people used to hang ropes at their chests (to hang on to when tired) in the prayer." 1 11 Qatadah said, jCfil £\$ Z} }We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} "No, by Allah, He did not make it a thing of distress. Rather, He made it a mercy, a light and a guide to Paradise.",2) Allah said, iBut

only as a Reminder to those who fear (Allah).} Allah revealed His Book and sent His Messenger[^] as a mercy for His servants, so that the person who reflects may be reminded. Thus, a man will benefit from what he hears of the Book of Allah, it is a remembrance in which Allah revealed what He permits and prohibits. His saying, }A Revelation from Him (Allah) Who has created the earth and high heavens.} means, This Qur'an, which has come to you, O Muhammad, is a revelation from your Lord. He is the Lord of everything and its King. He is Most Able to do whatever He wills. He created the earth with its low depths and dense regions. He created the lofty heavens with their high altitudes and At-Tabari 18:269. [2i At-Tabari 18:269.

323 Surah 20. Ta Ha (1-8) (Part-16) subtleties.' It has been reported in a Hadith, which At-Tirmidhi and others graded as authentic, that the density of each sky of the heavens is the distance of five hundred years travel and the distance between it and the next heaven is also five hundred years.¹¹¹ Concerning Allah's statement, iThe Most Gracious Istawd the Throne.} A discussion concerning this has already preceded in Surat Al- A'raf, so there is no need to repeat it here. ¹²¹ The safest path to take in understanding this, is the way of the Salaf (predecessors). Their way was to accept that which has been reported concerning this from the Book and the Sunnah without describing it, reinterpreting it, resembling it to creation, rejecting it, or comparing it to attributes of the creatures. Concerning Allah's statement, f Cj L2£,; Cj jgi\ 4 uj iTo Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and all that is between them, and all that is under the soil.} This means all of this is owned by Him and in His grasp. It is all under His control, will, intent and judgement. He created all of this, He owns it and He is the God of all of it. There is no true God other than He and no Lord other than He. Concerning Allah's statement, iand all that is under the soil.} Muhammad bin KaT) said, "This means that which is beneath the seventh earth."¹³¹ Concerning Allah's statement, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:185. The scholars consider this text to be authentic only from one of the Companions See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf (7 :54) At-Tabari 18:271

Muhammad), He is Allah, there is no God except Him. He the Owner of the Best Names and the most lofty attributes.' jQ' Jfc jJ jl jyii is i9. And has there come to you the story of Musa?} 410. When he saw a fire, he said to his family: "Wait! Verily, I have seen a fire; perhaps I can bring you some burning brand therefrom, or find some guidance at the fire."} A Discussion of the Message of Musa From this point, Allah begins to mention the story of Musa, how revelation began to come to Him, and Allah's speaking directly to him. This occurred after Musa had completed the time agreed upon between he and his father-in-law that he would herd sheep. He was traveling with his family, and it has been said that he was headed for the land of Egypt, after having been away from it for more than ten years. He had his wife with him and he became lost on the way during a cold, wintry night. Therefore, he settled down, making a camp between some mountain passes and mountains that were covered with snow, sleet, dense clouds, darkness and fog. He began to try to make a fire with a kindling device he had with him, in order to produce some light, as was customary. However, it would not kindle anything and it even stopped giving off sparks. While he was in this condition, he saw a fire from the side of the mountain. It appeared to him to be a fire glowing from the right side of the mountain from where he was. He then announced the good news to his family saying, 4.0? * Qi iVerily, I have seen a fire; perhaps I can bring you some burning brand} This means a flame from a fire. In another Ayah he said, ior a burning firebrand.} [28:29]^ This is a coal that has a burning flame. 46&J pi}

that you may warm yourselves.} [28:29] This proves that it was in fact cold weather at that time. Concerning his statement, isome burning brand This proves that it was dark. In reference to his statement, iorfind some guidance at thefire.} This means someone who can guide me to the road. This proves that he lost the road. This is as Ath-Thawri reported from Abu Said Al-ASvar, from 'Ikrimah, from Ibn 'Abbas that he said concerning Allah's statement, jt jJ \$} iorfind some guidance at thefire.} "This means someone who will guide me to the road. They were cold and had lost their way. Then, when he (Musa) saw the fire he said, 'Either 1 will find someone who can guide us to the road, or at least I can bring you all some fire that you can kindle with.' "[1 flj • j) j'jitj ofi dliu (\$iy Ijili £jb} ^-*1) iJ V ii' Ijl jjj) ^ oik 'i o* aJ Vi . U-> {J-ii jf IfUi-i alf't w* .ts IV ^ '.a. ill. And when he came to it (the fire), he was called by name: "O Musa!"} 112. "Verily, I am your Lord! So take off your shoes; you are in the sacred valley, Tuwa."} 113. "And I have chosen you. So listen to that which will be revealed (to you)" } 114. "Verily, I am Allah! There is no God but Me, so worship m At-Tabari 18:277.

Me, and perform Salah for My remembrance."} 415. "Verily, the Hour is coming - and 1 am almost hiding it - that every person may be rewarded for that which he strives."4 416. "Therefore, let not the one who believes not therein, but follows his own lusts, divert you therefrom, lest you perish."} The First Revelation to Musa Allah, the Exalted, says, 40U} 4And when he came to it,} This is referring to the fire when he approached it. 4He was called by name: "O Musa!"} In another Ayah it says, 4>& 4He was called from the right side of the valley, in the blessed place, from the tree: "O Musa! Verily, I am Allah."}[28 :30 However, here Allah says, A&j \$ 4Verily, I am your Lord!} meaning, 'the One Who is talking to you and addressing you,' 4So take off your shoes;} 'Ali bin Abi Talib, Abu Dharr, Abu Ayyub and others of the Salaf said, "They (his sandals) were from the skin of a donkey that was not slaughtered." It has also been said that he was only commanded to remove his sandals due to respect for the blessed spot. Concerning Allah's statement, m At-Tabari 18 :278

328 Tafslr Ibn KathTr iTinva 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "It is the name of the valley."111 Others have said the same. This is merely mentioned as something to give more explanation to the story. It has also been said that it is a figure of speech, which comes from the command to place his feet down. It has also been said that it means 'doubly sacred' and that Tuwa is something that has repetitious blessings. However, the first opinion is most correct. It is similar to Allah's statement, /p {/ >« * . v \ , • \V- , \Sy* ijo&W aljJb iWhen his Lord called him in the sacred valley of Tuwa.} [79:16] Allah's statement, GV;£> 4And I have chosen you.} is similar to His statement, 41 have chosen you above men by My Messages, and by My speaking (to you).} [7:144] This means over all human beings of that time. It has also been said that Allah said, "O Musa, do you know why I chose to speak to you directly out of all of the people?" Musa said, "No." Allah then said, "Because 1 have not made anyone humble himself as much as you have humbled yourself." Concerning Allah's statement, 4&y. Q tf2&} 4So listen to that which will be revealed.} "Now listen to what I say to you and what I reveal to you." '•)[V lii 3 -J)[] 4 Verily, I am Allah! There is no Cod but Me,} This is the first obligation upon all responsible people of age, that they know that there is no God worthy of worship except m At-Tabari 18:281.

Allah alone, Who has no partners. Concerning Allah's statement, iso worship Me,} This means, "Single Me out alone for worship, and establish My worship without associating anything with Me." iand

perform Salah for My remembrance.} It has been said that this means, "Pray in order to remember Me." It has also been said that it means, "And establish the prayer whenever you remember Me." There is a supporting evidence for this second statement in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from Anas, who said that the Messenger of Allah 3g said, <i>l lil '4* 3^ i'kZai\ jc- Jij lip ^Whenever one of you sleeps past the prayer, or he forgets to pray, then let him pray when he remembers it. For verily, Allah said, iAnd perform Salah for My remembrance.^ In the Two Sahihs it is reported from Anas that the Messenger of Allah sg said, nJlJi 'jl IJJ V lil I jtdSvi LfL— jl jt- a ^Whoever slept past tire prayer, or forgot it, then his expiation is that he prays it when he remembers it. Tlrere is no expiation for it other than f/i«fV21 Concerning Allah's statement, iVerily, the Hour is coming} This means that it is established and there is no avoiding it. It will be and it is inevitable. Concerning Allah's statement, &} m Ahmad 3:184. 121 Fath Al-Bari 2 :84 , Muslim 1 :477

— TafsTr Ibn Kathir \$1 am almost hiding it} Ad-Dahhak related from Ibn 'Abbas that he used to recite it as, "I almost kept it hidden - from myself."* 11 Ibn 'Abbas then would say, "Because nothing is ever hidden from Allah's Self.'^l 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, 41 am almost hiding it "This means that no one knows its appointed time except Me (Allah)."131 Allah also said, 'fj£ \$ -V c&Lt 4&} 4Heavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden.} [7:187] This means that its knowledge weighs heavily upon the dwellers of the heavens and the earth. Concerning Allah's statement, 4,>ij uj j-i:y 4that every person may be reivardedfor that which he strives.} I will establish it and it is inevitable. I will certainly reward every person who does something, according to what he did." f->-i - }J> ,v; jji jUu jZ} 4So whosoever does good equal to the weight of an atom shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of an atom shall see it.} [99:7-8] 4You are only being requitedfor what you used to do.} [52:16] Allah said, ; iyji y & yi} 4Therefore, let not divert you the one who believes not therein,} Fath Al-Qadir 3 :361 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :563 At-Tabari 18:285.

r\r mm3 ^ Q£*^< SijJ^b\j j_-lUicliil'ol. C'jJ A^VlijL^iijS\$'j A-cli ^^ fS&<* > «" > S*"Z * > *. *4 ' { '*' ^jjijuj \$£j <siJ^ j-p>j4:o&yif ^ JL^ 'JB^ 4y^c*3ji^-*J* lA !) IaitJ150 l^LilU0&jr^i </v . »^«i^ <4 'f. *4ii->'J0 \$JUj' 24>J&0 j£Jli0V^li^oCi0£cTi)jS3lj0j£J3Jls i^waujc-aito^^ .uy-uj^ii-a /••l«*// // J//./-^ .tx ^ ^ ^ ^ # K\$ sy*<iUl£u>JUJjEJ C-AJJ» The address here is directed towards all individuals who are responsible (and capable of taking heed to this message). This means, "Do not follow the way of the person who does not believe in the Hour (Day of Judgement) and he only pursues his desires in this worldly life. He disobeys his Lord and only follows his desires. Whoever behaves like these people, then verily he has failed and lost. 4lest you perish. This means that you will be destroyed and J ruined. / <. ?*-i:i *// / «^ / > ** •! X „ \ , J<JU Alt Jp 4And what will his wealth avail him when he goes down (in destruction)?} [92:11] 'Sj crt^*& Ift J^j !SW i J> Jtt ijv'y.jii. jL-;! iSjj Uj> V_> &£. JU 1^ . ^ 'iji Li^iJU ,v?^>yii Jtt ^jlS Ij-i T.-?n ^2-J 417. "And w/iaf is that in your right hatid, O Musa?"} 418. He said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean, and wherewith I beat down branches for my sheep, and wherein I find other uses."} 419. (Allah) said: "Cast it down, O Musa!"}

332 Ta/sir Ibn Kathir ^20. He cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} 421 . Allah said : "Grasp it andfear not ; We shall return it to itsformer state."} The Stick ofMusa turned into a

Snake This was a proof from Allah for Musa and a great miracle. This was something that broke through the boundaries of

what is considered normal, thus, it was a brilliant evidence

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3497–3547]

that none but Allah could do. It was also a proof that no one could come with the likes of this (from mankind) except a Prophet who was sent (by Allah). Concerning Allah's statement. $\text{\pounds j}$ iAnd what is that in your right hand, O Musa?} Some of the scholars of Tafsir have said, "He (Allah) only said this to him in order to draw his attention to it." It has also been said, "He only said this to him in order to affirm for him what was in his hand. In other words, that which is in your right hand is a stick that you are familiar with. You will see what We sire about to do to it now." iAnd what is that in your right hand, O Musa?} This is an interrogative phrase for the purpose of affirmation. s&} iHe said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean..." I lean on it while I am walking. iand whemoith I beat down branchesfor my sheep,} This means, 1 use it to shake the branches of trees so that the leaves will fall for my sheep to eat them.' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Qasim reported from Imam Malik that he said, "[It is] when a man places his staff into a branch and shakes it so that its leaves and fruit will fall without breaking the stick. It

333 Surat 20 IB. Ha.^2-35) (Part-16) is not the same as striking or beating." 11 Maymun bin Mahran also said the same. Concerning his statement, 'n* 4j} \$and wherein Ifind other uses.} This means other benefits, services and needs besides this. Some of the scholars took upon themselves the burden of mentioning many of these obscure uses. Concerning Allah's statement, i(Alldh) said: "Cast it down, O Musa!"} "Throw down this stick that is in your right hand, O MQsa." ctt iHe cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} This means that the stick changed into a huge snake, like a long python, and it moved with rapid movements. It moved as if it were the fastest type of small snake. Yet, it was in the form ofthe largest snake, while still having the fastest ofmovements. imoving quickly.} moving restlessly. Concerning Allah's statement, iWe shall return it to its former state.} the form that it was in, as you recognized it before. uiC j; sj- jA It (0* 'AJcL ^Aj} d Ja> 4 gt' ft &j. dl lilt ££ 4 \$\$> ink ^g 4 i\$yi£m && \$ in* * \$\$ \$-0 ,l ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :564 .

334 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 422. "And press your (right) hand to your (left) side: it will come forth ivhite (and shining), ivithout any disease as another sign"} 423. "That We may shoiv you (some) ofOur greater signs."} 424. "Go to Fir'awn! Verily, he has transgressed."} 425. He said : "O my Lord! Open for me my chest."} 426. "And ease my taskfor me;" } 427. "And loosen the bwtfrom my tongue," } 428. "Tltat they understand my speech."} 429. "And appointfor me a helperfrom myfamily," } 430. "Hanoi, my brother."} 431. "Increase my strength with him," } 432. "And let him share my task," } 433. "That we may glorify You much," } 434. "And remember You much," } 435. "Verily, You are ever seeing us."} The Hand ofMusa turning White without any Disease This is the second sign of Musa. That is Allah has commanded him to place his hand into the opening of his garment, as is clearly stated in another Ayah. It mentioned here merely as a passing reference, saying: oil ill (Ji5,\j} 4Attd press your hand to your side :} Allah said in another Ayah, dXj j,^&& 4And draw your hand close to your side to be freefrom

fear. These are two signs from your Lord to Fir'awn and his chiefs.} [28:32] Mujahid said, jt ill LLi-ij} 4And press your hand to your side :}

“This means put your palm under your upper arm.” 11 ' When MOsa put his hand into the opening of his garment and brought it out, it came out shining as if it were a half moon. Concerning His statement, hi 'O'- }it will come forth white, without any disease} This means without any leprosy, ailment, or disfigurement. This was stated by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and others.¹² Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “He brought it out, and by Allah, it was as if it were a lamp. From this Musa knew that he had surely met his Lord, the Mighty and Sublime.”³¹ This is why Allah says, && hi hx-ji} iThat We may show you (some) of Our greater signs.} Allah commanded Musa to go to Fir'awn to convey the Message Allah said, 'k &Jt di^} }Co to Fir'axon! Verily, he has transgressed.} This means, “Go to Fir'awn, the king of Egypt, whom you left Egypt fleeing from, and invite him to the worship of Allah alone, Who has no partners. Command him to treat the Children of Israel well and to not torment them. For verily, he has transgressed, oppressed, preferred the worldly life and forgotten the Most High Lord.” The Supplication of Musa i(Musa) said "O my Lord! Open for me my chest, and ease my task for me."} 111 At-Tabari 18:297. 121 At-Tabari 18:297,298. 131 At-Tabari 18:298.

Musa requested his Lord to expand his chest for his mission. For verily, He was commanding him with a great task and a weighty affair. He was sending him to the mightiest king on the face of the earth at that time. He was the most arrogant and severe of all people in his disbelief, and He had the largest army and the most powerful kingdom. He was the most tyrannical and the most obstinate of rulers. His case was such that he claimed not to know Allah at all, and that he knew of no god for his subjects other than himself. Along with this, Musa lived in his home for a period of time as a child. He stayed in Fir'awn's own room and slept on his bed. Then, after this, he killed one of their people and feared that they would retaliate by killing him in return. Thus, he fled from them and remained an outlaw during this entire time. Then, after all of this, His Lord sent him to them as a wamer calling them to worship Allah alone, without associating partners with Him. This is why he said, iO my Lord! Open for me my chest, and ease my task for me.} This means, “I cannot perform this task if You do not help me, aid me and support me.” life oi iAnd loosen the knot from my tongue, that they understand my speech.} This is referring to the lisp that he had. This lisp was a result of an incident when he was presented a date and a hot coal stone and he placed the coal on his tongue instead of the date. A detailed explanation of this story is forthcoming in the following chapters. However, he did not ask Allah to remove this affliction all together. Rather, he asked for removal of his stammering so the people would understand what he intended in his speech. He was only asking for what was necessary to deliver his message. If he had asked for the removal of his affliction in its entirety, it would have been cured for him. However, the Prophets do not ask for any more than what is required. Therefore, he was left with the remnants of this accident that took place with his tongue. Allah informed of what Fir'awn said concerning him,

337 Surah 20. Ta Ha (22-35) (Part-16) Sv+i y> isM 'ji j* °S*- y \$\$ 4Am] not better than this one who is despicable and can scarcely express himself clearly?⁴³ :52 This means that he is not eloquent in speech. Concerning Allah's statement, '&\$ oj !/.y 4 iAnd appoint for me a helper from my family, Harun, my brother. This was also a request from Musa concerning something not pertaining to himself. That was his request for the assistance of his brother, Harun. Ath-Thawri reported from AbU Said, from

'Ikrimah, who said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Harun was made a Prophet at the same moment that Musa was made a Prophet." 1 11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'A'ishah went out intending to perform 'Umrah and stopped to camp among some bedouins. While she was among them she heard a man say, "Which brother in this life was the most beneficial to his brother?" The people said, "We do not know." The man said, "By Allah, I know." 'A'ishah said, "I said to myself about his swearing, that he should not swear such an oath, singling himself out as knowing what person was of most benefit to his brother." The man said, "It is MUsa, when he asked for prophethood to be bestowed upon his brother." Then 'A'ishah said, "By Allah, he has spoken truthfully." This is why Allah commended Musa by saying, iAnd he was honorable before Allah.\$[33:69] Concerning MUsa's statement, .ft ilncrease my strength with him.\$ Mujahid said, "This means to makemy back strong." Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:567.

4And let him share my task.} make him my consultant in this matter. 1\$><4 sy 4That we may glorify You much, and remember You much .} Mujahid said, "A servant of Allah is not considered of those who remember Allah much until he remembers Allah while standing, sitting and lying down."111 Concerning his statement, iVerily, You are ever seeing us. This means in Your choosing us, giving us the prophethood and sending us to Your enemy, Fir'awn. So unto You is all praise for this. cH di zz4 k ±4 Jj j^j 4 •ii.fc 3r^ \ '4 *43* '4 4 j 4^zj~ym »&0 ji \ f:V & ^^ 4 4tij 4^ o; l4ij oiii 0> Vj ^ 2l> atuiy 436. (Allah) said: "You are granted your request, O Musa!" 437. "And indeed We conferred a favor on you another time (before)."} 438. "When We inspired your mother with that which We inspired."} 439. "Saying: 'Put him (the child) into the Tabut and put it into the river; then the river shall cast it up on the bank, and there, an enemy of Mine and an enemy of his shall take him.' And I endued you with lovefrom Me, in order that you may be brought up underMy Eye."} 440. "When your sister went and said: 'Shall I show you one who will nurse him?' So We restored you to your mother, that she might cool her eyes and she slwuld not grieve. Then you did kill a man, but We saved you from great distress and tried you with a heavy trial."} Al-Qurtubi 14:186.

Glad Tidings of the acceptance of Musa's Supplication and the Reminder ofthe Previous Blessings This is a response from Allah to His Messenger, Musa, for what he requested from His Lord. It also contains a reminder of Allah's previous favors upon him. The first was inspiring his mother when she was breastfeeding him and she feared that Fir'awn and his chiefs would kill him. Musa was bom during a year in which they (Fir'awn's people) were killing all of the male children. So she placed him in a case and cast him into the river. The river carried him away and she became grieved and distressed, as Allah mentioned about her when He said, & LjJaii\j J X}! .*J sijJ o o! iAnd the heart of the mother ofMusa became empty. She was very near to disclose his (case) had We not strengthened her heart.} [28:10] So the river carried him to the home of Fir'awn. iThen the people of Fir'awn picked him up, that he might becomefor them an enemy and a (cause of) grief.} (28:8) Means that this was a destined matter, decreed by Allah. They were killing the male children of the Israelites for fear of Musa's arrival. Therefore, with Allah having the great authority and the most perfect power, He determined that Musa would not be raised except upon Fir'awn's own bed. He would be sustained by Fir'awn's food and drink, while receiving the love of Fir'awn and his wife. This is why Allah said, 4c?* ciHc 1) Jj jit, j Jje iand there, an enemy of Mine and an enemy of his shall take him. And I endued you with lovefrom Me,} This means that I made your enemy love you. Salamah bin Kuhayl said, 4£ lia £&,} iAnd I endued you with lovefrom Me,}

"This means, 1 made My creatures love you.' "11 ' iitt order that you may be brought up under My Eye.} Abu Imran Al-Jawni said, "This means, *You will be raised under Allah's Eye.' "21 Concerning Allah's statement, 4When your sister went and said: 'Shall I show you one who will nurse him?' So We restored you to your mother, that she might cool her eyes} When he was accepted into the house of Fir'awn, women were brought in attempts to find someone who might be able to nurse him. But he refused to breast feed from any of them. Allah, the Exalted, says, >4® iAnd We had already forbidden (other) foster suckling mothers for him} \28:12] Then, his sister came and said, c*\$& iShall I direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?} [28:12] She meant, "Shall I guide you to someone who can nurse him for you for a fee?" So she took him and they went with her to his real mother. When her breast was presented to him, he took it and they (Fir'awn's family) were extremely happy for this. Thus, they hired her to nurse him and she achieved great happiness and comfort because of him, in this life and even more so in the Hereafter. Allah, the Exalted, says here, V) JoS^ 2)'s iSo We restored you to your mother, tltat she might cool her eyes and she shoidd not grieve.} 111 At-Tabari 18:303. 121 Fath Al-Qadir3:367.

342Surah 20. Ta Ha (40-44) (Part-16 This means that she should not grieve over you. iThen you killed man,} This means that he killed a Coptic person (the people of Egypt, Fir'awn's people). 4^ Oi ibut We saved you from great distress This is what he was feeling due to Fir'awn's family intending to kill him. So he fled from them until he came to the water of the people of Madyan. This is when the righteous man said to him, O; o*= iFear you not. You have escaped from the people who are wrongdoers.} [28:25] 633&S HI gm'3 Vi A *>.^ x xx lljs 1^viLiisUl—iioisj V)Ifile x > X xx xx X * *£> xx*x *< . X x » xx / ^ Z*^x x>X Xj^ XX jjX x^ X 'T'xX »" xttjt- *x ^yii JjU, j ^ J Is (jljl yifl.Us^ s£tf Jis(Ij^ j33jo^J^Jj3> •Tf^ »/, V*Y*i/ «/•£* x >x x^ XX x •/•.* *? . X 'i-*** ^c^-i <""*!* jo* ^ o^* |T o^ju Jjk\ 05~? ^J*r & iH£ * iss &\$&i 'aii ja\$& 3 i'Zbir* ') 440. Then you stayed a number of years with the people of Madyan . Then you came here according to the fixed term which I ordained (for you), O Musa!} 441 . And 1 have chosen you for Myself.} 442. Go you and your brother with My Ayat, and do not, you both, slacken and become weak in My remembrance.}

i<— lil ilUkJl ^jjJl i£j!j Jlii 3li jt l>y^* tjjA-ji !(Jli t ^_nj : jii uAdam and Musa met and Musa said, "You are the one who made things difficult for mankind and you caused them to be evicted from Paradise." Adam said, "Are you the one whom Allah chose for His Message, and He selected you for Himself and He revealed the Tawrah to you?" Musa replied, "Yes." Then Adam said, "Did you find that it was preordained upon me before He (Allah) created me?" Musa replied, "Yes." Therefore, Adam defeated Musa's argument.^ Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this narration. Concerning Allah's statement, 4Co you and your brother with My Ayat,\$ This means with My proofs, evidences and miracles. idsj 4And do not, you both, slacken and become weak in My remembrance> 'Ali bin Abi Talhah related from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "This means do not be slow. "I3 ' Mujahid reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means do not be weak." The meaning here is that they should not slacken in the remembrance of Allah. Rather, they both should remember Allah during their meeting with Fir'awn so that the remembrance of Allah can be an aid for them against him. The remembrance of Allah would be their strength and their power that would defeat him. Allah's statement; oyJt d', 4Go both of you to Fir'awn, Verily, he has transgressed.^ *** That is before intercession on the Day of Resurrection 121 Fath Al-Bari8 :288 , Muslim 4 :2043,2044 131 At-Tabari 18:312.

means that he has rebelled and become haughty and insolent against Allah and he has disobeyed Him. And speak to him mildly, perhaps he may accept admonition or fear (Allah).} This Ayah contains a great lesson. Even though Fir'awn was the most insolent and arrogant of people and Musa was the friend of Allah among His creation at that time, Musa was still commanded to speak to Fir'awn with mildness and softness. Therefore, their invitation to him was with gentle, soft and easy speech that is used by one who is a close friend. This is so that the message may have more effect on the souls, and so it would have deeper and more beneficial results. This is as Allah, the Exalted, says, *And invite (mankind) to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching, and argue with them in a way that is better.* [16:125] Concerning Allah's statement, *perhaps he may accept admonition or fear (Allah).*} This means that perhaps he will recant from that which he is in of misguidance and destruction, if or he will fear} meaning that he will become obedient due to fear of Allah. This is as Allah says, *For such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.* [25:62] Thus, to remember means to recant from that which is dangerous, and fear means to attain obedience. *ujj l l V J l o' 3' L3* -1*^4 J 13] L*

^L>r 1 % ji&i \$ j-jG 'C& tg^uS <>• J@ v'jJ' J £4j -6 U) ;; iy!SjLif ,>• j .iCj <ji illL 445. Bof/i 0/ them said: "Our Lord! Verily, I fear lest he should hasten to punish us or lest he should transgress."* 446. He (Allah) said: "Fear not, verily, I am with you both, hearing and seeing 447. "So go you both to him, and say: 'Verily, we are both Messengers of your Lord, so let the Children of Israel go with us, and torment them not; indeed, we have come with a sign from your Lord! And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance!'" 448. 'Truly, it has been revealed to us that the torment will be for him who denies, and turns away.' " } Musa's fear of Fir'awn and Allah's strengthening Him Allah, the Exalted, informs that MQsa and Harun pleaded to Allah, expressing their grievance to him: *4(^4" o' 3 4^ 0^ 4* Verily, I fear lest he should hasten to punish us or lest he should transgress.} They meant that Fir'awn might seize them unexpectedly with a punishment, or transgress against them by tormenting them, when they actually did not deserve it. Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said that transgress here means, "To exceed the bounds." 4He (Allah) said: "Fear not, verily, I am with you both, hearing and seeing."} meaning; "Do not fear him (Fir'awn), for verily, I am with you and I hear your speech and his speech as well. I see your place and I see his place as well. Nothing is hidden from Me of l 1 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :580

346 Tafslr Ibn Kathir your affair. Know that his forehead is in My Hand, and he does not speak, breathe, or use any force, except by My leave and after My command. I am with you by My protection, My help and My support." 4So go you both to him, and say: "Verily, we are both Messengers of your Lord. Musa admonishes Fir'awn Concerning his statement, ^indeed, We have come with a sign from your Lord!} meaning with evidence and a miracle from your Lord. 4And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance!} meaning, "peace be upon you if you follow the guidance.' Because of this, when the Messenger of Allah jg wrote a letter to Heraclius, the emperor of Rome, beginning with, *ji> \$\\ jii J^5^ ^ .^1 ii 4ii vltj; 4jlpJu i JLt LI 1 ^jA jjL 4)1 o/n f/ie* Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. From Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah, to Heraclius the emperor of Rome. Peace be upon him who follows the guidance. Tims, to proceed: Verily, I invite you with the invitation of Islam . So accept Islam and you will be safe, and Allah will give you a double reward.»|11 Due to this, Musa

and Harun said to Fir'awn, if && % U\ 'A a q f: '§ f 4And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance! Truly, Fath Al-Bdri 1 :42

it has been revealed to us that the torment will be for him who denies, and turns away In His flawless revelation, Allah has revealed to us that torment is prepared exclusively for those who reject the signs of Allah and turn away from His obedience. As Allah says, i j, \£SX !:§& * ft 4Then for him ivho transgressed all bounds, and preferred the life ofthis world, Verily, his abode will be Hellfire [79:37-39] Allah, the Exalted, also says, iTherefore I have warned you of a blazing Fire. None shall enter it save the most wretched. Wlw denies and turns away.} [92:14-16] Allah also says, 4So he neither believed nor prayed! But on the contrary, he belied and turned away.} [75:31-32] This means that he denied with his heart and turned away by his actions. jC Li jli ;,£v'cfJ> Jr if ^3 CfJ' L; Cs3j oli Af.J-Oi SfJ ? “ i t< 1 • Sf ..C Fir"awn said: "Wlw then, O Musa, is the Lord of you two?"} 450. [Musa] said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright."} 451. [Fir'atvn] said: "What about the generations ofold?"} 452. [Musa] said: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord, in a Record. My Lord neither errs norforgets." The Conversation between Musa and Fir'awii Allah, the Exalted, informs about Fir'awn that he said to Musa, in his rejection of the existence of a Supreme Maker and Creator, Who is the God of everything and his own Lord and Owner:

\$Who then, O Musa, is the Lord ofyou two?} meaning “Who is the one who called you forth and sent you? For verily, I do not know him and I have not given you any god other than myself.” i(Mfisa) said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright."} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “He is saying that He created a mate for everything.” 1 11 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “He made the man a man, and the donkey a donkey and the sheep a sheep.” Layth bin Abi Sulaym reported from Mujahid that he said, “He gave everything its form.” Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said, “He fashioned the creation of every moving creature.” Said bin Jubayr said concerning His statement, \$L i(Who) gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright.} “He gave each of His creatures what is suitable for its creation.”*2 ' Therefore, He did not give man the form of a wild beast, nor did He give wild beasts the form of the dog. Likewise, the dog’s form is not like the sheep’s. He also gave creature a suitable spouse, and He influenced everything towards that mate. There is no species of creation that is exactly like smother species. They are different in their actions, their forms, their sustenance and their mating. Some of the scholars of Tafsir have said that this statement, “He gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright,” is similar to Allah’s statement, 4b¥ iAnd Who has measured; and then guided.} [87:3] 111 AMabari 18:316. [2] Al-Qurtubi 11:204.

This means He measured out an ordained amount (of sustenance, actions, etc.) and then guided His creatures to it. He wrote the deeds, the appointed times of death and the provisions. Then, the creatures traverse upon that and they are not able to avoid it, nor are they able to abandon it. In this Ayah Musa is saying that our Lord is the One Who created the creation, measured out its ordainment and compelled the creatures to that which He wanted. o\$> SCu i(Fir'awn) said: "What about the generations ofold?"} The most correct opinion concerning the meaning of this, is that when Musa informed Fir'awn that his Lord Who sent him is the One Who creates, sustains, ordains and guides, Fir'awn began to argue, using the previous generations as a proof. He was referring to those people of old who did not worship Allah.

In other words, "If the matter is as you say, then what happened to those people? They did not worship your Lord. Instead they worshipped other gods besides Him." Musa said to him, in response to this, that if they did not worship Allah, then Allah knows precisely what happened to them and He will give them just recompense for their deeds, as is written in Allah's Book (of decrees). This Book is called Al-Lawh Al- Mahfuz (The Preserved Tablet) and it is the Book of Deeds. % 4S }My Lord neither errs nor forgets .} This means that nothing eludes Him and He does not miss anything, whether it is small or great. He does not forget anything and His Most Exalted knowledge is described as encompassing everything. Blessed be He, the Exalted, the Most Holy and free of any imperfections. The knowledge that creatures have has two deficiencies. The first is that it does not completely encompass anything, and the second is that the creature is prone to forget after knowing. Therefore, Allah has declared Himself above such deficiencies. C4 £# &m« qpsz p& ^yj 4 5) [4> £>0 oi.

4 ^ • i—>j& *cjj1 juJy <53. W?io /las made earth for you like a bed; and has opened ways for you therein, and has sent down loater (rain) from the sky. And We have brought forth with it various kinds of vegetation .} 454. Eat and pasture your cattle; verily, in this are Aydt for men of understanding.} 455. ThereofWe created you, and into it We shall return you, andfrom it We shall bring you out once again.} 456. And indeed We shoived him (Fir'awn) all Our Aydt, but he denied and refused.} The Completion ofMusa's Reply to Fir'awn This is from the completion of Musa's speech concerning the description of His Lord when Fir'awn asked him about Him. He (Musa) said, sity 4He Who gave to each thing itsform and nature, then guided it aright.} Then, Fir'awn attempted to present some argumentative rebuttal during Musa's reply. Yet, Musa continued by saying, "He is the One Who made the earth as a bed for you." Some recited the word as Mihadan and others recited it as Mahdan, which means 'a place of rest that you settle down upon.' It also may mean "that which you stand upon, sleep upon or travel upon its back." 4&J.qp JCj} 4and has opened waysfor you therein.} This means, 'He made roads for you to walk upon their shoulders.' This is just as He, the Exalted, said. 4And placed therein broad highways for them to pass through, that they may be guided.} [21:31]

iatid has sent down waterfrom the sky. And We have brought forth with it various kinds ofvegetation .} referring to the various species of plants, such as vegetation and fruits. Some are sour, some are sweet, some are bitter and there are other kinds as well. iEat and pasture your cattle (therein);} meaning, 'something that is food for you and a palatable fruit for you, and something that is for your cattle as fodder for them, both green and dry.' 4 Verily, in this are Ayat.} This means proofs, signs and evidences. jjii ifor men of understanding.} meaning those who possess correct and upright intelligence realizing that there is no god worthy of worship except Allah, and there is no true Lord other than Him. b6p£ P4 ^ThereofWe created you, and into it we shall return you, and from it We shall bring you out once again.} meaning, 'the earth is your beginning. For your father, Adam, was created with dirt from the surface of the earth. You also will be returned to the earth. This means that you will become dirt when you die and decay.' The statement, "And from it We shall bring you out once again," means, 4 jJL) iyliSj i— (j>) iOn the Day when He loill call you, and you will answer ivith His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while!} [17:52] This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, / . • / > . *• s * * >- y* . / "'i . . 4He said: "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, andfrom it you shall be brought out."} [7:25]

Jr <Xjd—j?" <4j-^5U-J^cJ is \j£0 llsr^oJUllaj-lJUi^pdi\j<_>jSviL\$js Lijb <CJ;i >1 'll <^ -1'i >- '*> ' ' .
> •''. Y" >-JJJl—il^Jiy'jr-sJ *•54' >' '\-'>y'''. <&> , 'Crf ' ' JzJo^'4l^ '-^iyjJ£^<&>&' 0^^TgiljgfcI^ t«
a>\lii showed Fir'awn all of the Signs but He did not believe Concerning Allah's statement, 'J& (jt &X
i# Q} 4And indeed We showed him (Fir'awn) all Our Aydt, but he denied and refused.} This means that
the proofs, signs and evi- dences were establi- shed against Fir'awn and he saw them with his own eyes,
but he still denied and rejec- ted them due to his disbelief, abstinence and transgression. This is as
Allah, the Exalted, says, 4}jkj lit (tr- 1 I*: 4And they belied them wrongfidly and arrogantly, though
they themselves were convinced thereof. [27:14] LX jX-l* **f- y»«~» r&uCSi ,av .iyy^i ^L*Ji ot bligl
<J'j (yj 3U ^.iSy /UIX V Ucy> lillij iA0 457. He (Fir'awn) said : "Have you come to drive us out of our
land with your magic, O Musa?"} 458. "Then verily, we can produce magic tire like thereof; so appoint
a meeting between us and you, which neither we nor you shall fail to keep, in an open place where both
shall have a

just and equal chance."} 459. (Musa) said: "Your appointed meeting is the day of the festival, and let
the people assemble when the sun has risen (forenoon)." } Fir'awn describes Musa's Proofs as being
Magic and Their Agreement to hold a Contest Allah, the Exalted, informs of what Fir'awn said to Musa
when he showed him the great proof. This great sign to Fir'awn was Musa casting down his stick which
became a huge snake, and his pulling his hand out from under his arm while it was glowing white
without any illness. At this, Fir'awn said, "This is magic that you have brought to us to bewitch us and
conquer the people, so that they will follow you. Then you will outnumber us." Fir'awn then said, "Your
plan will not work. We have magic just like yours, so do not let yourself be deceived by that what you
are doing." 4^ 4so appoint a meeting between us and you,} Meaning, 'a day that we can come together
to present some of our magic to confront yours. It will be at a specified place and time.' With this, Musa
said to them, 4Your appointed meeting is the day of festival,} That was the day of their celebration and
their New Year's festivity. It was a holiday for them when they took vacation from their work and came
together for a large gathering. This day was selected so that all of the people could witness the power of
Allah to do whatever He wills. They would see the miracles of the prophets and the futility of magic to
contest the supernatural prophetic powers. This is why Musa said, 4S® Zk 4and let the people
assemble} meaning all of them. 4Z> 4when the sun has risen (forenoon).}

meaning in the morning, just before noon. In this way the contest will be most visible, well lit, apparent
and obvious in plain view. This is the way of the Prophets. Their work is always clear and apparent. It is
never something hidden, or something for sale. This is why he did not say that the meeting should be at
night, but rather, it was to be held during the bright part of the day. Ibn 'Abbas said, "The day of their
festivity was the day of 'As/tCrd'."111 As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said, "It was the day of their
great celebration." Said bin Jubayr said, "It was the day of their great bazaar." These statements are not
contradictory. I say that Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his armies on a day similar to this, just as is
confirmed in the SahihJ21 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "It was a flat place where all of
the people were on the same level, having an equal view of the event. There was nothing there that
would obstruct the view so that some people could see what others did not."131 £m==* (Jp ii/Xi V -*.
fl . V,cjS Jr £^»«i Oyyj C at J&rj*-. i? W'if. * £» gil Z> &Sp }p i60. So Fir'awn withdmv, devised his
plot and thei came back.} 461 . Musa said to them : "Woe unto you! Invent not a lie against Allah, lest
He should destroy you completely by a torment. And surely, he ivho invents a lie (against Allah) ivill

fail miserably 462 Then they debated one with another what they must do, and they kept their talk secret.} 463. They said: "Verily, these are two magicians. Their object is to drive you out from your land with magic, and to take you away from your exemplary way."} 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthu.r4 :540 , that is the 10th of Muharram. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :288 At-Tabari 18:323.

464. "So devise your plot, and then assemble in line. And whoever overcomes this day loill be indeed successful ."4 The Meeting of the Two Parties, Musa's Propagation of the Message and the Magicians Allah, the Exalted informs that when Fir'awn and Musa agreed to an appointed meeting at a specified place and time, Fir'awn began to gather some magicians from the cities of his kingdom. Every person who had any affiliation with magic at that time was summoned, and magic was very widespread and in demand at that time. This is as Allah says, 4And Fir'awn said: "Bring me every ivell-versed sorcerer."4 [10:79] Then, the day came. It was the day when all of the people gathered, which was well-known, being the day of the festival. Fir'awn was there sitting upon his throne surrounded by the elite officials of his kingdom. The subjects were all standing on his right and his left. Then, Musa came forward leaning upon his stick accompanied by his brother Harun. The magicians were standing in front of Fir'awn in rows and he was prodding them, inciting them and encouraging them to do their best on this day. They wanted to please him and he was promising them and inspiring them. They said, oJ b} pj& (3\$ ^ ^ ol & ofo iWill there surely be a reward for us if we are the winners? He (Fir'awn) said: "Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near (to myself)." [26:41-42] V 3^3} 4M.iisa said to them : "Woe unto you! Invent not a lie against Allah..." This means, "Do not make an illusion before the people of something that is not real, making it appear as if it were a creature, when it is not really a creature. If you do this, then you would be lying on Allah."

ilest He (Allah) should destroy you completely by a torment . This means, 'He will destroy you with a destructive punishment that will not spare anything, or anyone.' 4 "...And surely, he who invents a lie will fail miserably." Tlten they debated one with another what they must do,} It has been said that this means that they argued among themselves. So one of them said, "This is not the speech of a magician, but it is the speech of a Prophet." Another said, "No, he is only a magician." There are other opinions that have been mentioned about what they discussed. And Allah knows best. Allah's statement, iand they kept their talk secret.} means, they held secret counsel among themselves about this matter. 4They said: "Verily, these are two [Hadhan] magicians..." This is a way of speaking with some of the Arabs and this Ayah has been recited according to the grammar of their dialect. There are also others who recite it as, j) Which carries the same meaning, "Verily, these are two [Hadhayn] magicians." This is the popular style of language in Arabic grammar. The grammarians have extensive discussions in reply to the first recitation and its grammatical explanation, but this is not the place for such a discussion. The main point is that the magicians said among themselves, "You all know that this man and his brother (Musa and HarQn) are two knowledgeable magicians who are quite aware of the skill of magic. They want to defeat you and your people today and conquer the people, causing the masses to follow them. They want to fight against Fir'awn and his armies, and they are seeking victory over him. And their ultimate goal is to expel

you from your land." Concerning Allah's statement, iand to take you away from your exemplary way.} This means, they want to expose this way (of yours) openly, which is magic.' For verily, they were

considered great because of their magic. They had wealth and sustenance because of this magic. They were actually saying, "If these two (Musa and Harun) are victorious, they will destroy you and expel you from your land. In doing so, they will be the first individuals to do so, and they will be given great power of leadership without you." Ibn 'Abbas mentioned concerning Allah's statement, and to take you away from your exemplary way.} "This means their kingdom, which they were in, and their livelihood."111 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said, "This superior way means that which they were upon." i<Lp p pg*. \&} iSo devise your plot, and assemble in line.} This means, "All of you come together in one row, and throw that which is in your hands at one time in order to dazzle the eyes (of the people) and defeat this man and his brother." iAnd whoever overcomes this day will be indeed successful.} meaning "Between you and us. As for us (the magicians), we have been promised to be given an abundance of power and sovereignty. And in reference to him (Mdsa), He will gain great leadership." pit*; ijill J; Jt» (> Jj' o' ,jtt J Ul d Ui^ S&. ^ Uij U oL _ * j L 111 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :396.

358 Tafslr Ibn Kathfr 4 'jir* vi/ li*'« pU Ijaf Jjte 465. They said: "O Musa! Either you throiv first or xoe he the first to throio?"} 166. [Musa] said: "Nay, throio you (first)!" Then behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they movedfast.} 167. So Musa conceivedfear in himself.} 468. We (Allah) said: "Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand."} 469. "And throiv that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain."} 470. So the magicians fell doivn prostrate. They said: "We believe in the Lord ofHdriin and Musa."} The Competition, Musa's Victory, and the Magician's Faith Allah, the Exalted, informs about the magicians when they met Musa, that they said to Musa, i'S J Zfr 4"Either you throiv first..."} meaning, "you go first." 4 5*1' j; ju Jy jfid ji ui_, 4"or we be the first to throiv?" (Musa) said: "Nay, throiv you (first)!"} This means, "you magicians should go first so that we can see what magic you are going to perform and so that the true state of their affair will become obvious to the people.' SM p <: 4Then behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they moved fast.} In another Ayah it says that when they threw,

359Surah 20. Ta Ha (65-70) (Part-16 {Then said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win!"} [26:44] And Allah, the Exalted, says, iThey bexoitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them, and they displayed a great magic.} [7:116] Here, He says in this Surah, S*. (^C*r iThen behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they movedfast.} They were a large numbered group and each one of them threw a stick and a rope until the valley became full of snakes piled on top of each other. Concerning Allah's statement, 4'ip.&y *** 'i-? iSo Musa conceivedfear in himself.} This means that he feared for the people that they would be tested and deceived by their magic before he could even have a chance to throw what was in his right hand. Thus, Allah revealed to him at the right moment, to throw what was in his right hand, which was the stick. When he did so, it swallowed what they had made. It became a huge, monstrous creature with legs, a neck, a head and fangs. It went after these ropes and sticks until none of them remained, except that it was devoured and swallowed by this beast. At the same time, the magicians and all of the people were watching with their own eyes, seeing this amazing event in broad daylight. Thus, the miracle was performed and the evidence was clear. The truth prevailed and the magic was proven to be falsehood. This is why Allah said, / ' » ,/ » / I •> ^ M /• i' ' • ' /; \ XtU* \yLm0 Li)7 iThat which they have made is

only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain.} So when the magicians saw the event and witnessed it with

their own eyes, while they were knowledgeable of the various tricks and methods in the sciences of magic, they knew with conviction that what Musa had done was not magic or illusionary tricks. They recognized that it was the truth without any doubt. They knew that no one had any power to do this except for One Who says for a thing "Be," and it is. Therefore, when this happened, they fell down into prostration to Allah. They said, "We believe in the Lord of all that exists, the Lord of Musa and Hartin!" This is why Ibn 'Abbas and Ubayd bin TJmayr both said, "At the beginning of the day they were magicians and at the end of the day they were outstanding witnesses of faith." The Number of Magicians Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The magicians were seventy men who were magicians in the morning, but witnesses of faith by the time evening came."*21 Ibn Abi Hatim also reported that Al-Awza! said, "When the magicians fell down in prostration, Paradise was raised up before them until they were looking at it."131 It is reported from Said bin Jubayr that he said concerning Allah's statement, 4<& iSo the magicians fell dawn prostrate "They saw their places (in Paradise) made clear before them while they were in their prostration." Tkrimah and Al-Qasim bin Abi Bizzah both said the same.*4 471. (Fir'awn) said: "Believe you in him before I give you At-Tabari 18:340, 13:36. Ibn Abi Hatim 7:2428. At-Tabari 18:334. * At-Tabari 18:334.

permission? Verily, he is your chiefwho has taught you magic. So I will surely cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, and I will surely crucify you on the trunks of date palms, and you shall surely know which of us can give the severe and more lasting torment.}" 472. They said: "We prefer you not over what have come to us of the clear signs and to Him (Allah) Wlw created us. So, decree whatever you desire to decree, for you can only' decree (regarding) this life of the world.""} 473. "Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faidts, and the magic to which you did compel us. And Allah is better as regards reward in comparison to your reward, and more lasting."} Fir'awn's turning against the Magicians, His threateningThem and Their Reply Allah, the Exalted, informs of Fir'awn's disbelief, obstinance, transgression and haughtiness against the truth in favor of falsehood. When he saw what he saw of the magnificent miracle and the great sign, and he saw those whose help he sought accept faith in the presence of all of the people, and he was absolutely defeated, he began to behave arrogantly and cast accusations. He resorted to using his esteemed honor and might against the magicians. He warned them and threatened them saying, if p:} iBelieve you in him (Musa)} This means, "Do you have faith in him?" ip 3K 3 f3} ibefore I give you permission?} meaning, "I have not commanded you to do so, by which you have rebelled against me." Then he said a statement that he, the magicians and all creatures knew was a forgery and an utter lie. i'jp 4 'pp Z\} iVerily, he is your chiefwho has taught you magic.} meaning "You all only took your magic from Musa and you

have made an agreement with him against me and my subjects, that you would help him be victorious." Allah says in another Ayah, iSurely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people, but you shall come to knoio.} [7:123] Then he began threatening them. He said to them, iSo I will surely cut offyour hands and feet on opposite sides, and I will surely crucify you on the trunks ofdate palms,} meaning, "I will certainly make an example of you, I will kill you in a public execution." Ibn 'Abbas said, "Thus, he was the first person to ever do this (public execution,

crucifixion).” This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. Concerning Allah’s statement, & 1*3 u;1&%} 4And you shall surely know ivhich of us can give the severe and more lasting torment .} This means, “You say that my people and I are astray and that you (magicians), Musa and his people are following correct guidance, but you will come to know who will be punished and remain punished.” So when he attacked with this and threatened them, their souls eased them because of their belief in Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. They exclaimed, 4 Zjt U Je j3£j J iThey said: “\le prefer you not over what have come to us of the clear signs...”} meaning, “We do not chose you over the guidance and conviction that we have received.” iand to Him (Allah) Who created us.} It could be that they were swearing, “By He Who has created m At-Jabari 13:34.

us.” It also could be connected in meaning to the clear signs mentioned before it. In this case it would mean, “We do not prefer you over our Originator and Creator, Who produced us from a beginning that was nothing. He created us from clay (or mud). Therefore, He alone deserves worship and humility and you do not (Fir’awn)!” iSo decree u<lulever you desire to decree, “Do whatever you wish and whatever your hands are able to achieve.” ifor you can only decree (regarding) this life of the world.} meaning, “You only have power in this world and it is a world that will come to an end. Verily, we are hoping in the eternal abode.” U jiJ t£, fc\ Z[] 4 Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us ourfaults,} “Whatever evils that we did.” It specifically means, “which we were forced to do of magic, in order to oppose the sign of Allah and the miracle of His Prophet.’ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning Allah’s statement, iand the magic to which you compelled us.} “Fir’awn took forty boys from the Children of Israel and commanded that they be taught magic at Al-Farama. ’ He said, Teach them knowledge that no one in the land knows.” Ibn ‘Abbas then said, “They were of those who believed in Musa and they were of those who said, ^ A fort at the shore of Egypt, between Al-Arish, which is a town in Northern Egypt, on the Mediterranean and Al-Fust&t, which is the ancient Islamic city south of present-day Cairo. See Mu’jam Al- Butdan.

J rn 'ftp?&P\SPpPiA>'<p•PPp\y^S. -'•'. T'-^i""Ti<s£ ^i " i-C". . .'. -Y. j ui» iyy j^ΛLSll^w'UcaSII J V iCw^ sscj^p:ju ^ -* ^ / ^ SS •Zt,. M fvt|^.S? >4&> ir/'" 'is' XtS 9- *C Ep 0**!>T<^3jl^cyu^vVV * .Si sjoX a jo c; &> ^Jof j. 4We /woe believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faults, and the magic to which you did compel us.}”111 ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said the same.121 Allah’s statement, XM" j,t{ '“!> J*- 4And Allah is better as regards reward in com- parison to your reward, and more lasting . means, “He is better for us than you.” i^j} iand more lasting.} More lasting in reward than what you pro- mised us and made us aspire to. It is apparent that Fir’awn (may Allah curse him) was bent upon their punishment, and that what he did to them was a mercy from Allah for them. This is why Ibn ‘Abbas and others of the Salaf said, “They woke up in that morning as magicians, but they became witnesses of faith by the evening.” jj> ji U*y .^jlj «>*j iQteA 'tj Ifj OjX ^ ^4*- jJ 06 UjJi A) Pi 0“ /Λ^ J& k& zfri <g oj <£ p.4\$ i%& * i]> 474. Verily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal, then 111 Ad-DurrAl-Mcmthur 5:587. 121 At-Jabari 18:341.

365Surah 20. Ta Ha (74-76) (Part-16 surely, for him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live.} i75. But whoever comes to Him as a believer, and has done righteous good deeds, for such are the high ranks,} 476. ‘Adn Gardens, under which rivers flow, wherein they will abide forever, and such is the reward of those who purify themselves.} The Magicians admonish Fir’awn The clear intent of this is to

be a completion of what the magicians admonished Fir'awn with. They warned him of the vengeance of Allah and His eternal and everlasting punishment. They also encouraged him to seek Allah's eternal and endless reward. They said, %4. o iVerily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal,} This means, whoever meets Allah on the Day of Judgment while being a criminal. "it% Cifk V f+r *£ hf} itthen surely, for him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live.} This is similar to Allah's statement, 4Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die, nor shall its torment be lightened for them. Thus do We requite every disbeliever!} [35:36] Allah also said, -5 ^<#3i%&4< 4But it will be avoided by the wretched, who will enter the great Fire. There he will neither die nor live.} [87: 11-13] ^ YV Lljf. ^ 4And they will cry : "O Malik (Keeper of Hell)! Let your Lord made an end of us." He will say: "Verily, you shall abide forever."} [43:77]

ojjtiU 4)1 jU3li lili i LIS U» 1>-jS iL* c^Jl 1 liijjS/l «Paradise has one hundred levels and between each level is a distance like the distance between the sky and the earth. Al- Firdaws is the name of the highest of its levels. From it springs thefour rivers and the Throne is above it. Therefore, ivhen you ask Allah, then ask Him for Al-FirdawsJ1,1 This narration was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi.12 ' In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, t^l\$J i/r-* tfjJlj <& " j>till jjjj Ui <j* >t <!>• :JU jdVl Jjlli ill; !ji)l J^3 U :l_^U - u 1 4)b cJl^j « Verily, the people of the Tliyyin will see those xvho are above them just as you see the fading star in the horizon of the sky, due to the different status of virtue between them .» The people said, "O Messenger of Allah, these are the dwellings of the Prophets." He replied, «0/ course. Arid I swear by the One Whom my soul is in His Hand, (it is for) men who had faith in Allah and they believed the Messengers .»|31 In the Sunan collections this narration is mentioned with the additional wording, iLHilj Ijl jjj "And verily Abu Bakr and 'Umar are of them and they will be mostfavored .»|4 ' His saying, 111 Ahmad 5:316. 121 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :238 Fath Al-Bari 6:368, Muslim 4:2177. For the meaning of Uliyyin , see Surat Al-Mutaffifin (83 :18-21) Abu Dawud 4:287, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10:141 and Ibn Majah

1^.) 4Adn Gardens, meaning established as a residence. It is merely used here in reference to the high ranks mentioned previously. 4^i. jiJiVf ja sffr} iunder which riversflow, wherein they will abideforever,} meaning that they will abide in it for eternity. <& *& iand such is tire reward of those who purify themselves.} One who purifies himself from dirt, filth and associating partners with Allah. This is the person who worships Allah alone, without ascribing partners to Him, and he follows the Messengers in the good they came with all that they claim. Vj fejJ 4-ijH 'll UK ti tiij> j^A vinL* cl &y> iJJ j} HI A*J» &J. <Wl vo(*T"f V* o; (*»»*) / , «^ 477 . And indeed We revealed to Musa: "Travel by night with My servants and strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken nor being afraid."} 478. Then Fir'awn pursued them with his hosts, but the sea [Al-Yamm] completely ovenwhelmed them and covered them up.} 479. And Fir'awn led his people astray, and he did not guide them.} The Children of Israel leave Egypt Allah, the Exalted, informs that He commanded Musa to journey at night with the Children of Israel, when Fir'awn refused to release them and send them with Musa. He was to take them away from Fir'awn's captivity. Allah expounds upon this in Surahs other than this noble Surah. Musa left with the Children of Israel, and when the people of Egypt awoke in the morning they found that not a single one of them remained in Egypt. Fir'awn became extremely furious. He sent callers into all of the cities to gather together his army from all of his

lands and provinces. He said to them, (3 jirjj iVerily, these indeed are but a small band. And verily, they have done what has enraged us.) [26:54-55] Then when he gathered his army and organized his troops, he set out after them and they followed them at dawn when the sun began to rise. Hji} 4And when the two hosts saw each other} [26:61] This means that each person of the two parties was looking at the other party. dp J@@ ley 4The companions ofMusa said: "We are sure to be overtakett." (Musa) said: "Nay, verily, with me is my Lord. He will guide me." [26:61-62] MQsa stopped with the Children of Israel and the sea was in front of them and Fir'awn was behind them. Then, at that moment, Allah revealed to Musa, 3, ft *is*&} 4And strike a dry path for them in the sea.} So Musa struck the sea with his stick and he said, "Split for me, by the leave of Allah." Thus, it split, and each separate part of the water became like a huge mountain. Then, Allah sent a wind to the land of the sea and it burned the soil until it became diy like the ground that is on land. For this reason Allah said, > Vic V L-k (j iand strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken...} This means being caught by Fir'awn. 4£Z %} inor being afraid.} meaning, "Do not be afraid of the sea drowning your people."Then, Allah, the Exalted, said,

J 'JSKS^ rlv iSg^siiSi ,<ujSu^J^y i\$P Z*' >/• ><> ^,'» »Z ^ /,, CSybJi&ijfnC LA0*00\Cj jfcLitjjJjo^tiCyI^Sj5GUjli ^Cs^0j JI5l— \Iag. . 4*a Li^KiSjl^jLjiljwe bliiJU l_j)U iThen Fir'awn pursued them with his hosts, but the sea [Al-Yamm] com- pletely overwhelmed them Al-Yamm means the sea. i^4 iand covered them up.} meaning, coveredthem up with a thing that was well-familiar to them in such a situa- tion, asAllah states; u 051 z^pt} i(i)& 4And He destroyed the overthrown cities. So there covered them that which did cover.} [53:53-54] As Fir'awn pursued them into the sea, misled his people and did not lead them to the path of correct guidance, likewise, he will go ahead of his people on the Day of Resurrection, and will lead them in to the Hellfire. And evil indeed is the place to which they are led. *4>i> jjP iX~ -£0>j '\$0 I# p0 ji ^} P* 1yj \s?*£ £0 *-» \0u 'tj f0ijj U 0:1. it0 4 ^L,iSXJt\ f Ut*> ^f-j <>"Lj0 Jj j±A . 'KjOSyk Jui t^s0 480. O Children of Israel! We delivered you from your enemy, and We made a covenant with you on the right side of the Mount, and We sent down to you manna and quail,}

(Saying) eat of the Tayyibdt wherewith We have provided you, and commit no transgression or oppression therein , lest My anger should justly descend on you. And he on whom My anger descends, he is indeed perished .4 482. And verily, I am indeed forgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous deeds, and then Ihtadd.4 A Reminder for the Children of Israel of Allah's Favors uponThem Allah reminds of His tremendous favors upon the Children of Israel and His numerous blessings. He saved them from their enemy, Fir'awn, and He relieved their eyes by drowning him and his hosts all at one time while they watched. Allah said, 4And We drowned Fir'awn people while you ivere looking. [2:50] Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, When the Messenger of Allahm came to Al-Madinah, he found the Jews fasting the day of Ashurd '. Therefore he asked them about it and they said, This is the day that Allah gave Musa victory over Fir'awn.' Then, the Prophet said, > > > ' ,, > 1 • l * *_r, »ayyai «We have more right to Musa (than them), so fast if." Muslim also recorded this narration in his Sahih. Then, Allah made a covenant with Musa and the Children of Israel on the right side of the Mountain, after the destruction of Fir'awn. This is the Mountain upon which Allah spoke to Musa and He told Musa's people to look at it when they requested to see Allah. It is also the same Mountain upon which Musa was given the Tawrah, while at the same time the Children of Israel began worshipping the

(statue of a) calf, as Allah relates in the forth coming Ayat. The manna and quails have previously been discussed in Surah Al-Baqarah and 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :288 I2 ' Muslim 1 :795 131 See Surat Al-Baqarah (2 :57) , and Surat Al-‘Araf(7 :160)

other Surahs. Manna was a sweet substance that descended upon them from the sky and the quail [Sa/tfd] was a type of bird that would fall down to them. They would fill every pot with them as ample provisions until the following day. This was a kindness and a mercy from Allah upon them. It was a manifestation of Allah’s good treatment of them. For this reason Allah says, iEat of the Tayyibdt wherewith We have provided you, and commit no transgression or oppression therein, lest My anger should justly descend on you.} This means, “Eat from this sustenance which I have provided for you, and do not transgress against My sustenance by taking it without necessity or you will be opposing what I have commanded you.” ilestMy anger should justly descend on you.} This means, “I will become angry with you.” -U» JXc jaj} iAnd he on whom My anger descends, he is indeed perished.} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means that he will indeed be made miserable.”111 Concerning Allah’s statement, sfj ^ i>j j^i} iAnd verily, I am indeedforgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous good deeds,} meaning, “Whoever turns to Me in repentance, then I will accept his repentance regardless of whatever sin he did.” Allah, the Exalted, even accepts the repentance of the Children of Israel who worshipped the calf. Concerning Allah’s statement, itf} m At-Tabari 18:347.

iwho repents,> This means to turn away from what one was involved in of disbelief, associating partners with Allah, disobedience ofAllah or hypocrisy. Concerning Allah’s statement, iand believes This means the person’s belief in his heart. 4&P iand does righteous deeds,} his action with his bodily limbs. Concerning Allah’s statement, 4and then Ihtada .} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means that he then does not doubt.” Qatadah said, iattd then Ihtada.} “This means he adheres to Islam until he dies.” We see here that there is a specific order in which these things are presented. This is similar to Allah’s saying, pt ip£ yrU of& iThen he became one of those who believed and recommended one another to perseverance and patience and recommended one another to pity and compassion .} [90:17] Li-J cyy j* -v " -dJuo It* J&y llSi ji CU jli sf. oi pj* (i pji JU>i' L_)- \Jj Jli 0* ! jLyl b£r liCLj ^-iy UiliJ l* [pli JwicSJgy p£2>} <0t s-- IJC yiii *_>• /J IjLI*. p 'ay'if>UJ' jlj pj' oj X> !s+ ft X> X?* -*-\$?» gy. “iP ip 4 r*.'ii«i At-Jabari 18:347.

374 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 483 . "And what made you hasten from your people, O Musa?4 484. He said: "Tim/ are close on my footsteps, and I hastened to You, O my Lord, that You might be pleased."4 485. (Allah) said: "Verily, We have tried your people in your absence, and As-Sdmiri has led them astray."4 486. Tfien Musa returned to his people in a state of anger and sorrozv [Asifj. He said: "O my people! Did not your Lord promise you a fair promise? Did theti the promise seem to you long in coming? Or did you desire that wrath should descend from your Lord on you, that you broke your promise to me?" 487. They said: "We broke not the promise to you, of our own will, but we xvere made to carry the weight of the ornaments of the people, then we cast them, and that was ivhat As-Samin suggested."4 488. Then he took out for them a calfwhich was mooing. They said: "This is your god, and the god of Musa," but he had forgotten. 489. Did they not see that it could not return them a word (for answer), and that it had no power either to harm them or to do them good? Musa goes to the Appointment with

Allah and the Children of Israel succumb to worship the Calf Allah relates what happened when Musa traveled with the Children of Israel after Fir'awn's destruction. jli *41* \$ U J**-' y*-* •*+> Jf'- ^ ^ x e3# * £ s 32 k s s&s pi 4 And they came upon a people devoted to some of idols. They said: "O Musa! Make for us god as they have gods." He said : "Verily, you are a people who know not. Verily, these people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in. And all that they are doing is in vain."} [7:138-139] Then, Allah made a covenant with Musa of thirty nights after which He added to them ten more nights. Thus, they were forty nights in all. The covenant was that he was to fast these

number of days, during both the day and night. Thus, Mflsa made haste to go to the Mountain and he left his brother, Harun, in charge over the Children of Israel. This is why Allah says, ,U Jtt i "And what made you hasten from your people, O Miisd?" He said: "They are close on my footsteps."} These means that they have arrived and are settled near the Mountain. J>j Qjejj iatid I hastened to You, O my Lord, that You might pleased.} meaning, "So You will be more pleased with me." be i(Allah) said: "Verily, We have tried your people in your absence, and As-Sadmin has led them astray."} Allah informs His Prophet, Musa, of what happened to the Children of Israel after he left them, and their deification of the calf that As-Samiri had made for them. During this time period, Allah wrote for Musa the Tablets, which contained the Tawrah. Allah said, iyi }£ jfl *&zy tly J-^=* uj 4 f \^fk=-j} ^ ijji-t ilujj i And We wrote for him on the Tablets the lesson to be drawn from all things and the explanation for all things (and said): "Hold unto these with firmness, and enjoin your people to take the better therein. I shall show you the home of evildoers."} [7 :145] This means, "I will show you the final outcome of what will happen to those who abandon My obedience and oppose My command." Concerning Allah's statement, iThen Miisa returned to his people in a state of anger and sorrow [Asif].}

376 Tafslr Ibtî Kathîr This means that after Allah informed him of what they were doing, he became extremely angry and upset with them. He was very worried for them. During this time he received the Tawrah, which contained their Shari'ah (Law), this was a great honor for them. For they were a people who used to worship other than Allah. Every person with sound reason and good sense could see that what they were doing was false and foolish. This is why Allah said that he (Musa) returned to them in a state of anger and sorrow. The word for sorrow used here is Asif, which is used to emphasize to the severity of his anger. Mujahid said, "In a state of anger and sorrow means worried." Qatadah and As-Suddi said, "Asif here means in a state of sadness because of what his people had done after him."*2 »-'Jej (iS2> jli^ 4 He (Miisa) said: "O my people! Did not your Lord promise you a fair promise? ..."} This means, "Did He not promise you in that which I have spoken to you, every good in this life and in the Hereafter, and the good end in the final outcome of things? You have already witnessed how He helped you defeat your enemy (Fir'awn) and He made you victorious over him and He blessed you with other bounties as well through His help." }Did then the promise seem to you long in coming?} meaning, 'in waiting for what Allah had promised you and forgetting His previous favors and the covenant that He made with you before.' iOr did you desire that wrath should descend from your Lord on you,} The word 'Or' here means 'Nay, but.' It is used here to separate between a previous item and a coming item. It is as if it is saying, "Nay, but you want to make permissible the anger At-Tabari 18:350. At-Tabari 18:350.

of your Lord upon you by what you have done. Therefore, you have broken your promise to me.” The Children of Israel said in reply to Musa’s blame and rebuke, “We broke not our promise to you of our own will,” Meaning by our power and our choice. Then, they began making lame excuses and they told him how they got rid of that which they were carrying of Coptic jewelry that they had borrowed from them (the Egyptian Copts) when they left Egypt. Therefore they cast it, meaning that they threw it away. Thus, it became a calf that made a moaning sound that would gradually rise in pitch. This calf was an ordeal, a hindrance and test. This is why Allah said, “...that was what As-Samiri suggested.” Then he took out (of the fire) for them (a statue of) a calf which was mooing.” Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This is your god, and the god of Musa.” “So they became religiously devoted to it (the calf) and they loved it with a love that they had never loved anything else with before.” Allah then says, “but he had forgotten.” This means that he abandoned what he was following of the religion of Islam. This is referring to As-Samiri.¹² * Allah says in refuting them and rebuking them, and also explaining to them their folly and foolishness in that which they had done, “Did they not see that it could not return them a word (for answer), and that it had no power either to harm them or to do them good?” 111 Tarikh At-Tabari 1 :422, At-Tabari 18:355. Tarikh At-Tabari 1 :424,425

This is about the calf. ‘Do they not see that it does not respond to them when they ask it and when they speak to it?’ and that it had no power either to harm them or to do them good? Meaning in their worldly affairs and matters of the Hereafter. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Nay, by Allah, the moaning sound of the calf was nothing but wind that would enter into its behind and come out of its mouth, thus causing it to make a sound.”¹¹¹ In a Hadith of Al-Fitun recorded from Al-Hasan Al-Basri, it is mentioned that this calf’s name was Bahmut.¹²¹ In reference to the excuse of these ignorant people, they claimed that they were merely ridding themselves of the jewelry of the Copts. In the process of doing so, they cast the jewelry (into the pit of fire) and ended up worshipping the calf. Thus, they were seeking to rid themselves of something detestable, but wound up doing something even worse. This is similar to an authentic narration reported from ‘Abdullah bin Umar. A man from Iraq asked him about the ruling of mosquitoes’ blood if it get on one’s garment. The man wanted to know if it is permissible to pray in such a garment or not. Ibn ‘Umar replied by saying, “Look at the people of Iraq. They killed the grandson of the Messenger of Allah *sg*, Al-Husayn, and yet they’re asking about the blood of the mosquito. (4b d\j -tjdi t?) *gj**& 490. And Hdriin indeed had said to them beforehand: “O my people! You are being tried in this, and verily, your Lord is (Allah) the Most Gracious, so follow me and obey my order. 491. They said: ‘We will not stop worshipping it, until Musa returns to us.’” (1 * An-Nasal in Al-Kubra. 6 :396 ^ An-NasaT in Al-Kubra 6 :396. This text is not considered authentic. Fath Al-Bari 10:440.

Harun prohibits them from worship of Calf and the Persistence of the Children of Israel in doing so Allah, the Exalted, informs of Harun’s attempt to prohibit them from worshipping the calf and his telling them that this was only a test for them. He told them that their Lord was the Most Beneficent, Who created everything and decreed for everything its just measure. He is the Owner of the Mighty Throne, the One Who does whatever He wants. 4 <4^ iso follow me and obey my order. Meaning, “Follow me in that which I am commanding you with and leave that which I forbid you from.” iThey said : “We will not stop worshipping it, until Musa returns to us.”} meaning, “We will not cease in our

worship of this calf until we hear what Musa has to say about it.” So they opposed Harun in this matter and they fought against him, nearly killing him. v fKi && & } . (JJ pj ftCj-P. xjf. Jju J IpL Pi fj jfp, 51X> 192. (Musa) said: "O Harun! What prevented you when you saw them going astray;" 193. "That you folloioed me not (according to my advice to you)? Have you then disobeyed my order?" 194. He (Harun) said: "O son ofmy mother! Seize (me) not by my beard, nor by my head! Verily, Ifeared lest you should say "You have caused a division among the Children of Israel, and you have not respected my ivord!""} What happened between Musa and Harun after Musa returned Allah informs of what happened when Musa returned to his people and saw the great matter that had taken place among them. With this he became filled with anger and he threw

down the Divine Tablets that he had in his hand. Then, he grabbed his brother HarUn by his head and pulled him towards himself. We expounded upon this previously in Surat Al-A'rdf, where we mentioned the Hadith, cguij's £ji jJt «Information is not the same as observation.^ Then, he began to blame his brother, Harun, by saying, \$What prevented you when you saw them going astray; that youfollowed me not?} meaning, "You should have informed me of this matter as soon as it happened." iHave you then disobeyed my order?} "In that which I entrusted to you," referring to Musa's statement, jZ \$Jx} iReplace me among my people, act in the right way and follow not the way of the mischief-makers.}[7:142] 4He (Harun) said: "O son ofmy mother!"} This mentioning of the mother was Harun's attempt to soften Musa's anger, because he was MUsa's biological brother and they had the same parents. The mentioning of the mother here is more delicate and profound in bringing about gentleness and mildness. This is why he said, 40 son ofmy mother! Seize (me) not by my beard, nor by my head!} This was Harun's excuse to Musa for being delayed from coming to him and informing him of the great mishap that Ahmad 1:271.

r\A mmyi yOlbi>l ,aj ojff&\$ tety 0^S\%p.J^z b\j Jfc\$ S-iyipijJie>2/-^l£-) -MH^^«3y^J J13f|p C\$J+--1Ja>*L33U Jlj3 J^3 ^// / ij, . / >/ < *> . "" ^ x #/» »4> (ill O' ^J^viA! (—Aife *- "Mill. ^llLj^iJ£=3£^J_ys>"jhellVcfJM^Uil (^4^i took place. He said, ^cAii- ^\} iVerily, I feared} meaning, "I was afraid to come after you and inform you of this, because I thought you might accuse me of leaving them alone and causing division between them." 4£&#> iand you have not respected my word!} This means, "And you did not take care of what I commanded you to do when I left you in charge ofthem." Ibn 'Abbas said, "Harun was respectful and obedient to Musa." ot Omauj *aj I^/v^ jv* U-j u->/noj JL> Lj ^ cJ_y* dfyx£s L^X.i S& *£ ^ii cijj^ di^ J 3% fe, V j> CfJ ^ *>1 V ufl lit E3l ^ 4 ^^ J^=> 495. (Miisa) said: "And what is the matter with you. O Samiri?" 496. (Samiri) said: "I saw what they saw not, so I took a (Qabdah) handful (of dust) from the (hoof) print of the (i| At-Jabari 18:359.

messenger and threio it. Thus my inner selfsuggested to me."} 497. Musa said: "Then go away! And verily, your (punishment) in this life will be that you will say: 'Touch me not)' and verily, you have a promise that will not fail. And look at your god to which you have been devoted. We ivill certainly bum it, and scatter its particles in the sea." ^98. Your God is only Allah, there is no God but Him. He has fidl knowledge of all things.} How As-Samirimade the Calf Musa said to As-Samiri, "What caused you to do what you did? What presented such an idea to you causing you to do this?" Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "As-Samiri was a man from the people of Bajarma, a people who worshipped cows. He still had the love of cow worshipping in his soul. However, he acted as

though he had accepted Islam with the Children of Israel. His name was Musa bin Zafar.” Qatadah said, “He was from the village of Samarra.”² ‘ii JLi^ i(Sdmiri) said: "I saw what they saw not."} This means, “I saw Jibril when he came to destroy Fir‘awn.” iso I took a handful (Qabdah) from the print of the messenger} This means from the hoof print of his (Jibril’s) horse.’³ This is

what is well-known with many of the scholars of Tafsir, rather

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3547–3554]

most of them. Mujahid said, iso I took a handful (Qabdah) from the print of the messenger} “From under the hoof of Jibril’s horse.” He also said, “The word Qabdah means a palmful, and it is also that which is grasped by the tips of the fingers.” Mujahid said, “As-Samiri 111 Tdrikh At-Tabari 1:424. ’2| At-Tabari 18:363. 131 At-Tabari 18:362.

threw what was in his hand onto the jewelry of the Children of Israel and it became molded into the body of a calf, which made a light moaning sound. The wind that blew into it was the cause of its sound.” Thus, he said, iand I threw it This means, “I threw it along with those who were throwing (jewelry).” iThus my inner self suggested to me.} This means that his soul considered it something good and it was pleasing to his self. The Punishment of As-Samiri and the burning of the Calf Thereupon, Y jyu J 4^ v-fcjk J^S} i(Musa) said: “Then go aioay! And verily, your (punishment) in this life ivill he that you will say: ‘Touch me not.’”} This means, “Just as you took and touched what was not your right to take and touch of the messenger’s foot print, such is your punishment in this life, that you will say, “Do not touch (me).” This means, “You will not touch the people and they will not touch you.” &&} iand verily, you have a promise This means on the Day of Resurrection. ithat will not fail.} you will have no way to escape it. Qatadah said, Y JyS oty ithat you ivill say: ‘Touch me not.’} “This is referring to a m At-Tabari 18:362.

384 Tafsir Ibn Kathir punishment for them and their remnants (i.e. those who have their disease) today still say ‘Do not touch.’” Concerning Allah’s statement, 4\$ci 3 ^y & if)} iand verily, you have a promise that will not fail.} Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Abu Nahlk said, “You will not be absent from it.” 11 ’ 4And look at your god} that which you worshipped, 4to which you have been devoted.} that which you established worship of, which was the calf. AA y4 '# iYour God is only Allah, there is no God but Him. He has full knmoledge of all things.} Mtisa was saying to them, “This is not your god. Your God is only Allah, the One Whom there is no true God except Him. Worship is not befitting to anyone except Him. For everything is in need of Him and everything is His servant. Concerning the statement, sly j£=> £*)} 4He has fill knowledge of all things.} The word 71m (knowledge) is in the accusative case for distinction. It means that He is the All-Knower of everything. 40* ’ft* 10} 4(Allah) surrounds all things in (His) knowledge.} (65:12) And He says, t’J-& %} 4And (He) keeps count of all things.} [72:28] Therefore, IM At-Tabari 18 :364

Mi*-^ v> iNot even the weight of a speck of dust escapes His knoivtedge (34:3| He also says, V}^% yC« ^Vf 4Nof <i /e<i/falls, but He knoivs it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is writteti in a Clear Record.} [6:59] And He says, #> t ^ ^ i.£=> 4 J* j&S 4>jj jit > VI ^:Vt j iib 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He

knoios its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} [11:6] The Ayat that mention this are numerous. ,<jU J* .. ^ ,]; ^~~= V W) ^ JJj ji U ^ iiUL 4_raij i99 . Thus We relate to you some information of what happened before. And indeed We have given you from Us a Reminder.} 4100. Whoever turns away from it, verily, they will bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection.} 4101. They will abide in that - and evil indeed will it be to load for them on the Day of Resurrection .} The Entire Qur'an is the Remembrance of Allah and mentioning the Punishment of Those Who turn away from It Allah, the Exalted, is saying to Prophet Muhammad sg, "We have told you (O Muhammad) the story of Musa and what happened with him, Fir'awn and his armies, just as it actually happened. Likewise, We relate to you the information of the past just as it happened, without any increase or decrease. We

also gave you a remembrance from Us, the Mighty Qur'an, no falsehood comes to it from before it or behind it.' It is a revelation from One Most Wise, Most Praiseworthy. No Prophet was given any Book like it or more complete than it, since the time of the previous Prophets who were sent, until their being sealed off with the coming of Muhammad No Prophet was given any Book containing as much information than the Qur'an about what has past and what would be. The judgement concerning the distinction between mankind is taken from it. Therefore, Allah says about it, iWhoever turns away from it,i This means whoever denies it and turns away from following its commands and instructions, while seeking guidance from other than it, then Allah will mislead him and send him on the path to Hell. This is why Allah says, iWhoever turns away from it, verily, they iwill bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection .> Burden here means sin. This is as Allah says, 'ij iBut those of the sects that reject it , the Fire will be their promised meeting place. [11:17] This applies generally to whoever the Qur'an reaches of the Arabs, the non-Arabs, the People of the Book and others. This is as Allah says, iThat 1 may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach. [6:19] The Qur'an is a final warning for everyone it reaches. Whoever follows it, then he is rightly guided and whoever opposes it and turns away from it, then he is misguided. He will be wretched in this life, and he is promised that on the Day of Resurrection his abode will be the Hellfire. For this reason Allah says,

4i-i 4*73\$ j>j< jyA joji ^PWioewer turns away from it, verily, they will bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection. They will abide in that.} [20 :100-101] They will not be able to avoid this or escape it. 4And evil indeed will it be that load for them on the Day of Resurrection .} '4fc*!r"p [*"4 (*f-" Ojr^>C .Jit.liy Xgf j&j J> gfi (X.¥ &4 & k tip# 4102. The Day when the Siir will be blown: that Day, We shall gather the criminals blue-eyed .)> 4103. They will speak in a very loiv voice to each other (saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten."4 4104. We know very well what they will say, when the best among them in knmoledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day!"\$ The Blowing of the Siir and the Day of Resurrection It has been confirmed in a Hadith that the Messenger of Allah was asked about the Sur and he replied, "It is a horn that will be blown into.» It has been related in a Hadith about the Siir, on the authority of Abu Hurayrah that it is a huge horn that has circumference as large as the heavens and the earth. Tlie angel Israfil will blow into it. 121 Another Hadith has been related which states that the Prophet sg said, «*J ji^j jl fEj\j j 0^1)1 ,Jdl Ji O/iJl v_~^L4j JjIS'd "How can I be comfortable when the one with the horn is Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:116. At-Tabarani in At-Tawal no.36.

holding it in his lips and his forehead is leaning forward, waiting to be given permission (to blow it). The people said, "O Messenger of Allah, what should we say?" He said, Jz iii &J- : \JJ> *Say: Allah is sufficient for us and what a good protector He is. Upon Allah we place our trust. s' Concerning His statement, fry 'J&jf 4And We shall gat\ver the criminals blue-eyed. It has been said that this means having blue eyes due to the severity of their horrifying situation. iThey will speak in a very low voice to each other. Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means whispering among themselves."*21 This means that some of them will be saying to others, <j£4jgJol» 4You stayed not longer than ten> meaning in the abode of the worldly life, you only tarried there for a little while. The time was equivalent to ten days or so. Allah, the Exalted, then says, io)A 4We know very well what they will say,\$ This means in their condition of conversing amongst themselves. Si iwhen the best among them in knowledge and wisdotn will say;} TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9:117. 121 At-Tabari 18:371.

389Surah 20. Ta Ha (102-104) (Part-16) the one with perfect intelligence amongst them, it*% iYou stayed no longer than a day!} This is because on the Day of Judgement they will sense the shortness of the worldly life within themselves. For the worldly life, with its repetitious time periods and successive nights, days and hours, is as if it is just one day. For this reason, on

the Day of Resurrection the disbelievers will think the worldly

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life was very short. By this they mean to prevent thie establishment of the evidence against them due to the shortness of time that they had. Allah says about this, > K: (y° (Mr iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour} until His statement. v^ 4but you knew not."} [30:55-56] Allah also says, pz& *a t jj} 4Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you.} [35:37] Allah, the Exalted, also says, <4& ' }• ji* jfjji j '£} VI 4(Allah will say): What number ofyears did you stay on earth? They will say: "We stayed a day or part ofa day. Ask of those who keep account." He (Allah) will say: "You stayed not but a little, ifyou had only known!"} [23:112-114] This means that you only remained in it (the earth) a little while. If you only knew, you would have preferred the eternal life over the temporal life. Yet, you conducted yourselves in an evil manner. You gave the present, temporary life precedence over the eternal and everlasting life.

390 Tafsir IbtI Kathir Ijj i)£jj 'i Icli J Jii JLU £ fkjky>} yii ^Z*-j % ^y- V jfM Vj 4>vc^ -Ji il05. And they ask you concerning the mountains. Say: "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust."} 4106. "Then He shall leave it as a level smooth plain."} 4107. "You will see therein no crookedness nor curve."} 4108. On that Day mankind will folloio strictly (the voice of) Allah's caller, no crookedness (that is without going to the right or left of that voice) ivill they slmv him (Allah's caller). And all voices will be humbled for the Most Gracious (Allah), and nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} The destruction of the Mountains, and the Earth becomes a Smooth Plain Allah says, 4And they ask you concerning the mountains.} This is a question, will they remain on the Day of Resurrection or will they cease to exist? itejf, i+U 4Sm/: "My Lord ivill blast them and scatter them as particles of dust."} This means that He will take them away from their places, wipe them out and remove them completely. iThen He shall leave it} referring to the earth; £&} 4as a level smooth plain.}

This means one expanse spread out. The word Qa' means a piece of land that is level and the word Safsafa is used to place emphasis on this meaning. It has also been said that Safsafa. means that which has no vegetation

growing in it. The first meaning is preferred, even though the second meaning is also included by necessity. In reference 1:0 this, Allah says, / «• // s »v 4 'yf Vj Ujc. i^i^ 4You will see therein no crookedness nor curve meaning, 'on that Day you will not see in the earth any valley, hill, or any place, whether low or elevated.' Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others of the Salaf all said the same. The People will rush towards the Voice of the Caller iOn that Day mankind will follow strictly Allah's caller, no crookedness iwill they shoio him> On the Day, they see these conditions and these frightening sights, they will hastily respond to the caller. Wherever they are commanded to go, they will rush to it. If they had been like this in the worldly life, it would have been more beneficial for them, but here it does not benefit them. This is as Allah says, 4How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us! [19:38] Allah also says, 4hastening towards the caller> Concerning Allah's statement, 4And all voices will be humbledfor the Most Gracious Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means they will be silent."12 ' As-Suddi also said the same. 111 At-Tabari 18 :372 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :598,599 121 At-Tabari 18:374.

J r\ K b^vj Ov yjilljS f: - - ".if - *. "A", ij&j, ,/• • qp \r£==>> ^ *T * v ^ **m* 9<f * l| T **^ ^^ ^ ^ |;- JJ I a ^-»a --pUUIa^ 1 /n |v»J ga ^A.Ja ^v:-ira^^'Jr*4"i>-'- J^tl•**}i-JiL*>t«^ jy **^ \. '-'*** t\^- It > > > if -r''' .a. rfhr 'gCJs 'j6j CL£aV^LUIJsUi 4& -Jj 4And nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} Sa'Id bin Jubayr related that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means the steps of feet." 111 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Qatadah, Ibn Zayd and others all said the same.12 ' 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said, idi^ 4And nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} "Hamsa means a hidden voice. "3 * This has also been repor- ted from 'Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak. Said bin Jubayr said, 4And nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} "Hamsa means the secret speech and the steps of feet." Uj |*£-J dj\i U ,Vy ^ <s?JD ^ o* j^j>} & :j& \$*t& * % {&- 4109. On that day no intercession shall avail, except the one At-Jabari 18:374. At-Jabari 18:375. At-Jabari 18:375.

.Surah 20. Ta Ha (109-112) (Part-16) 393 for whom the Most Gracious has given pertnission and whose word is acceptable to Him 4110. He knows what happens to them, and what will happen to them, but they will never encompass anything of His knowledge.} 4111. And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer. And he who carried wrongdoing, will be indeed a completefailure.} 4112. And he who works deeds of righteousness, while he is a believer, then he will have no fear of injustice, nor of any curtailment.} The Intercession and the Recompense Allah, the Exalted, says, 4On that day} the Day of Resurrection, 'i} 4no intercession shall avail.} meaning with Him (Allah). 4^y \$ (s(i} 0*\$ 4 oil &\} 4except the one for whom the Most Gracious has given permission and whose word is acceptable to Him.} This is similar to His statement, T*XE L^jil li 4Who is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} [2 :255] It is also similar to His statement, iCj il' oit o' oj •*1 is?M 4And there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.} [53 :26] He also says,

i <jj f»j <>"->' p. ^j. Vj^ 4And they cannot intercede except for him with whom He pleased. And they stand in awe for fear of Him.} [21:28] He also says, 4/J P yj} is ^Intercession with Him profits not except

for him ivhom He permits .} [34:23] And He says, 4 r*X}y^> Jtij jpll J ja 'j\ {ffi fyu f£} 4The Day that Ar-Ruh and the angels zwill standforth in rows, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious allows, and he will speak what is right.} [78:38] In the Two_ Sahihs it is reported from the leader of the Children of Adam and the Noblest of all the creatures to Allah, Muhammad jg: ;|ttOMl V gzZj tljL»-lo 4) I '£*~< j*j Sl.vj £ij\ U :JjZ p u jf ;U U _pij p ipJl i lj>- jjpj - «/ wi// come under the Throne and I will fall down into prostration. Then, I will be inspired to make praises (of Allah) that I am not able to recall them now. Allah will leave me in this condition as long as He wisltes. Then, He will say, "O Muhammad, raise your head. Speak and you will be heard, intercede and your intercession will be accepted." Then, a designated group will be allowed for me (to intercede on their behalf). Allah will then enter them into Paradise and I will return (to repeat the process again). s* 1 The Prophet sg mentioned doing this four times. May Allah's blessings and peace be upon him and the rest of the Prophets as well. In another Hadlth it also mentions that he said, Of Zf- Jliif J> jl£ If jliJl m Fath Al-Bari 8 :247, Muslim 1 :184.

ijtw I J -..3 A-ii j IS" j0 l jiiL 4-ii jt j's jji l ty*-y. l : 3yt y 1 ixL>- ^ ^ Ir* J&' S? L^^ ->? 53 nAllah, the Exalted, uhll say, "Bring out of the Fire whoever has a seed's iveight offaith in his heart." So a large number of people will be brought out. Then He will say, "Bring out of the Fire whoever has a half of a seed's weight offaith in his heart. Bring out whoever Ims the iveight of a speck of dust in his heart. Bring out whoever has the iveight of the smallest and tiniest particle of dust offaith in his heart. And the HacLith continues. Concerning Allah's statement, Uj jj*1 Oy u iHc knoivs what happens to them and what will happen to them,} He encompasses all creation with His knowledge. ibut they will never encompass anything of His knowledge.} This is like His statement, iAnd they will never encompass anything of His bwledge except that which He wills.} [2:255] Concerning Allah's statement, & </ 4 :j\$^ iAnd (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer.} Ibn 'Abbas and others said, "This means that the creatures will be humbled, submissive and compliant to their Compeller, the Ever Living, Who does not die, the Sustainer of all, Who does not sleep. ,2! He is the maintainer of everything. He 111 Path Al-Bari 13:481. 121 At-Jabari 18:377, 378.

396 Tafslr Ibn Kathir determines the affairs of everything and preserves everything. He is perfect in His Self. He is the One Whom everything is in need of and whom nothing could survive without. Concerning His statement, iAnd he who carried wrongdoing, will be indeed a complete failure. meaning on the Day of Resurrection. For verily, Allah will give every due right to the one who deserved it. Even the ram who lost its horn will be given revenge against the onewhohad horns. In the Sahih, it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, {ji plLI l Ifclij ^iii» dBeware of wrongdoing (or oppression), for verily, wrongdoing will be darknesses on the Day of Resurrection .» And the true failure is for whoever meets Allah while associating partners with Him. Allah the Exalted says, i"Verily, associating partrters with Me is the great wrongdoing. Allah's statement, iAnd he. who works deeds of righteousness, while he is a believer, then he will have no fear of injustice, nor of any curtailment After Allah mentions the wrongdoers and their threat, He then commends the pious people and mentions the judgement they receive. Their judgement is that they will not be wronged nor oppressed. This means that their evils will not be increased and their good deeds will not be decreased. This was stated by Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others. Zulm means an increase that comes from the sins of others

being placed upon the person, and Hadm means a decrease. Ahmad 2:106. Similar wording is with Muslim 4:1996. At-Tabari 18:379, 380.

4 And thus We have sent it down as a Qur'an in Arabic, and have explained therein in detail the warnings, in order that they may have Taqwd, or that it may cause them to have a lesson from it.} 4114. Then High above all be Allah, the True King. And be not in haste with the Qur'an before its revelation is completed to you, and say: "My Lord! Increase me in knowledge."} The Qur'an was revealed so that the People would have Taqwd and reflect After Allah, the Exalted, mentions that on the Day of Judgement both the good and the evil will be recompensed and there is no avoiding it, He then explains that the Qur'an was revealed as a bringer of glad tidings and a warner in the clear and eloquent Arabic language. There is no confusion or deficiency in it. 4 And thus We have sent it down as a Qur'an in Arabic, and have explained therein in detail the warnings, in order that they may have Taqwd of,} This means: so that they will leave off sins, forbidden things and lewd abominations. } or that it may cause them to have a lesson from it.} This means: to produce acts of obedience and deeds that will bring one closer to Allah. 4 dP' i Then High above all be Allah, the True King.} This means: Most Holy and Majestic is He, the True King, Who is Himself the Truth and His promise is true. Likewise, His threat is true, His Messengers are true, the Paradise is true,

398 Tafsir Ibt Kath Tr the Hellfire is true and everything from Him is true. His justice is that He does not punish anyone before warning them sending Messengers to them and granting excuses to His creatures, so that no one will have any argument or doubt (on Judgment Day). The Command to the Prophet ss; to listen to the Qur'an when it is revealed without making haste to recite it Concerning Allah's statement, O' J-i* irt O'v-ill; J*Co \$ And be not in haste with the Qur'an before its revelation is completed to you,} This is similar to Allah's statement, 4 r i Move not your tongue to make haste therewith. It is for {is to collect it and to give you the ability to recite it. And when We have recited it to you, then follow its recital. Then it is for Us to made it clear (to you).>(75:16-19) It is confirmed in the Sahih on the authority of Ibn 'Abbas, who said that the Messenger of Allah m, used to go through great pains to retain the revelation. In doing so he used to move his tongue rapidly with its recital . Then, Allah revealed this Ayah. This means that whenever Jibril would say an Ayah, the Prophet m, would say it with him due to his eagerness to memorize it. Then, Allah guided him to that which was easier and lighter in this matter, to relieve him of this difficulty. Allah said, i Move not your tongue to make haste therewith. It is for Us to collect it and to give you the ability to recite it.} [75:16-17] Meaning, "We will gather it in your chest, then you will recite it to the people without forgetting anything of it." m Path Al-Bari 1 :39

J ry W>^ f Si k f 'SZ0\$ &')W j3^ l*ifr ^J3vjj ^iAlSJ^aij iiiiil ijj© @cs^S/jQ jjlo^2^j^Xi'Si ^ And when We have recited it to you, then follow its recital. Tl en it is for Us to made it clear (to you).} [75:18-19] And He said in this Ayah, jJi iri d*"" 4/PP & 4 And be not in litiste with the Qur'an before its revelation is com- pleted to you,} This is a command to the Prophet sfe to listen quietly: Then, when the angel (Jibril) completes reciting to you, you recite it after him.' 4 and say: "My Lord! Increase me in knowledge."} meaning, "Give me more knowledge from You." Ibn 'Uyaynah said, "The Prophet sg did not cease increasing (in knowledge) until Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, took him (i.e. he died)." *^L3j £& if) *A p> & <Ji P* di^ | Vi iu-pj ^ J" 'j£» o) iji* "".(V.*' CfrAfi, '-?*>'* fp ^ ^^^ il VLE=*1i

"Kdr'. ^ *7^J jii' d* viljj Ja J'i cO-j> /// y'j > ' ' s" c^t' " ' /<' y *" .i' / / / »/ yn *,f .t fjU U ouu^ Lipy u_i OA-4 yu 4 AM v 1" /VJ ^r*r <*•*, y .y . i-r Pjp tJjj ota^t JLA^f ^ uUp_JAfr^jiwJrs~aM -"If " . . ' ,i ' i > .

4115. And indeed We made a covenant with Adam before, but he forgot, and We found on his part no firm willpower.} ill6. And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves to Adam." They prostrated themselves (all) except Iblis; he refused. ^ 4117. Then We said: "O Adam! Verily, this is an enemy to you and to your wife. So let him not get you both out of Paradise, so that you will be distressed."} 4118. "You will never be hungry therein nor naked."} 4119. "And you (wife) suffer not from thirst therein nor from the sun's heat."} 4120 . Then Satan whispered to him, saying : "O Adam! Shall I lead you to the Tree of Eternity and to a kingdom that will never waste away?"} 4121. Then they both ate of the Tree, and so their private parts became manifest to them, and they began to cover themselves with the leaves of the Paradise for their covering. Thus Adam disobeyed his Lord, so he went astray.} 4122. Then his Lord chose him, and turned to him with forgiveness, and gave him guidance.} The Story of Adam and Iblis Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Verily, man was named *Insan* only because he was given a covenant, but he forgot it (*Nasiya*) . 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported the same'2' from Ibn 'Abbas. Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that he forgot means, "He abandoned it."13 ' Concerning Allah's statement, 4}'& U10 4And when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves to Adam."} He, Allah mentions how Adam was honored and what respect was given to him. He mentions how He favored him over many At-Tabari 18:383. At-Tabari 18:383. '3| At-Tabari 18:383.

of those whom He created. A discussion of this story has already preceded in Surat Al-Baqarah, Surat Al-A'raf, Surat Al- Hijr and Surat Al-Kahf. It will also be mentioned again at the end of Surah Sad. In this story, Allah mentions the creation of Adam and that He commanded the angels to prostrate to Adam as a sign of honor and respect. He also explains the enmity of Iblis for the Children of Adam and for their father, Adam, before them. Due to this Allah says, iThey prostrated themselves (all) except Iblis; he refused.} This means that he refrained from prostrating and became arrogant. ^C±Xtrjtjj jJl jj* \j± j) fjlii biii> iThen We said: "O Adam! Verily, this is an enemy to you and to your wife..."} here wife refers to Hawwa'. 4So let him not get you both out of Paradise, so that you will be distressed.} meaning, 'Do not be hasty in doing something that will get you expelled from Paradise, or else you will be fatigued, discomforted and worried, seeking your sustenance. But here, in Paradise, you live a life of ease with no burdens and no difficulties.' H vf iu i[] 4 Verily, you will never be hungry therein nor naked.}

The reason that Allah combined hunger and nakedness is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3566–3570]

because hunger is internal humiliation, while nakedness is external humiliation. 4And you (will) suffer not from thirst therein nor from the sun's heat.} These two characteristics are also opposites. Thirst is the internal heat and being parched from lack of water, while the

sun's heat is the external heat. 4Then Satan whispered to him, saying: "O Adam! Shall I lead you to the Tree of Eternity and to a kingdom that will never waste away?"} It has already been mentioned that he caused them to fall through deception. iAnd he swore by Allah to them both: "Verily, I am one of the

sincere well-wishers for you both."} [7 :21] It has already preceded in our discussion that Allah took a promise from Adam and his wife that although they could eat from every fruit, they could not come near a specific tree in Paradise. However, Iblis did not cease prodding them until they both had eaten from it. It was the Tree of Eternity (Shajarat Al-Khuldj. This meant that anyone who ate from it would live forever and always remain. A Hadith has been narrated which mentions this Tree of Eternity. Abu Dawud At- Tayalisi reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet ss said, ijjiLui « Verily, in Paradise there is a tree ivhich a rider can travel under its shade for one hundred years and still not have passed it. It is the Tree of Eternity. Imam Ahmad also recorded this narration.¹² Concerning Allah's statement, iThen they both ate of the tree, and so their private parts became manifest to them,} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ubayy bin Ka'b said that the Messenger of Allah said, ¹¹¹ Musnad At-Tayalisi no.332. Similar is recorded by Al-Bukhari without the addition ; 'It is the Tree of Eternity.'. Ahmad 2 :455.

tlii «d>u *j[S jjb^ *'1 ' j''' 43Li Ji>- Cyfi- faj lll ml 'fi. O Ijj li Jjli i<J,U 4iP kj.» o'.»»JL)1 U-b t U ablli aL^jlli o^>w ayw OJL>- 13 '—~? S\ v^aiji iILaw^1 j£Jj iN v-ij la :JU 5 p->j : jli ^xU-i 4 Verily , Allah created Adam as a tall man with an abundance of hair on his head. He looked like a clothed palm tree. Then, when he tasted (the fruit of) the tree, his clothes fell off ofhim The first thing that became exposed was his private parts. So when he noticed his nakedness, he tried to run back into Paradise. However, in the process a tree caught hold of his hair (i.e. his hair urns tangled in a tree), so he ripped his hair out. Then, the Most Beneficent called out to him saying, "O Adam, are you fleeing from me?" When he heard the Words of the Most Beneficent, he said, "No my Lord, but I am ashamed. If I repent and recant would You let me return to Paradise?" Allah replied, "Yes.""¹¹¹ This is the meaning of Allah's statement, y£)t .0 J. fX #3} iThen Adam received from his Lord Words. And his Lord pardoned him.} [2:37] However, this narration has a break in the chain of transmission between Al-Hasan and Ubayy bin Ka*b. Al-Hasan did not hear this Hadith from Ubayy. It is questionable as to whether this narration can be correctly attributed to the Prophet sg Allah said, 4 j-i' Jjj Ji l. ,-f liiij} 4And they began to cover themselves with the leaves of the Paradisefor their covering.} ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 12:354. As the author noted, this Hadith is riot authentic. It was recorded with a connected chain by Al-Hakim, who considered it authentic. Adh-Dhahabi agreed. However, the chain contains Yahya bin Damrah , whose biography is unknown

some of you are an enemy to some others. Then if there comes to you guidance from Me, then whoever follows My guidance he shall neither go astray nor shall be distressed.} 4124. But whosoever turns away from My Reminder, verily, for him is a life ofhardship, and We shall raise him up blind on

the Day of Resurrection."}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3570–3586]

4125. He will say: "O my Lord! Why have you raised me up blind, while I had sight (before)."} 4126. (Allah) will say: "Like this Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded them, and so this Day, you will be neglected."} The Descent ofAdam to the Earth and the Promise of Good for the Guided and Evil for the Transgressors Allah says to Adam, Hawwa' and Iblis, "Get down from here:, all of you." This means each ofyou should get out of Paradise. We expounded upon this in Surah Al-Baqarah. &o# 4Some ofyou as enetnies to others.} [2:36] He (Allah) was saying this to Adam and his progeny and

iblls and his progeny. 1 Concerning Allah's statement, 4& jf. fy} 4Then if there comes to you guidance from Me,} Abu Al-'Aliyyah said, "This (guidance) means the Prophets, the Messengers and the evidence." 4C& VJ J~j*i Vi j^} 4T\en whoever follows My guidance he shall neither go astray nor shall be distressed.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "He will not be misguided in this life and he will not be distressed in the Hereafter."*2 0* Iff} ** At-Tabari 1 :549. At-Tabari 18:389.

iBut whosoever turns aioayfromMy Reminder,} This means, "Whoever opposes my command and what I have revealed to My Messenger, then he has turned away from it, neglected it and taken his guidance from other than it." iverily, foi him is a life of hardship,} meaning, his life will be hard in this world. He will have no tranquillity and no expanding of his breast (ease). Rather, his chest will be constrained and in difficulty due to his misguidance. Even if he appears to be in comfort outwardly and he wears whatever he likes, eats whatever he likes and lives wherever he wants, he will not be happy. For verily, his heart will not have pure certainty and guidance. He will be in agitation, bewilderment and doubt. He will always be in confusion and a state of uncertainty. This is from the hardship of life. Concerning His statement, iand We shall raise him up blind on the Day of Resurrection.} Mujahid, Abu Salih and As-Suddi said, "This means he will have no proof." 1 '* 'Ikrimah said, "He will be made blind to everything except Hell." This is as Allah says, /• • >> f-'ii t rfr'-A' rji iAttd We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrecti on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell.} [17 :97] This is why Allah says, 40 my Lord! Why have you raised me up blind, while I had sight (before).} This means in the life of this world. L> Lx.' At-Tabari 18 :394.395

407Surah 20. Ta Ha (127) (Part-16 {(Allah) will say: "Like this Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded than, and so this Day, you will be neglected.> Meaning, "When you turned away from the signs of Allah and dealt with them in the manner of one who does not remember them after they were conveyed to you. You neglected them, turned away from them and were heedless of them. Therefore, today We will treat you in the manner of one who has forgotten you." «L_j] ' y— 1 - ^ -a ' jXJU ^ 4So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this Day.} [7:51] For verily, the punishment will be a retribution that is based upon the type of deed that was done. However, forgetting the words of the Qur'an, while understanding its meaning and acting upon its legislation, is not included in the meaning of this specific threat. Yet, forgetting the words of the Qur'an has been warned against from a different aspect. It has been reported in the Sunnah that it is absolutely forbidden and there is a serious threat against one who forgets Qur'an (that he previously memorized). A.fZBt-Sv -"/t s.&i f •> •' .t ' "s:\ 4327. And thus do We requite him who transgresses beyond bounds and believes not in the Ayat of his Lord; and the torment of the Hereafter is far more severe and more lasting.} Severe Torment for Him Who bounds transgresses beyond Allah says: Thus We do requite those who transgress beyond bounds and belie the Ayat of Allah in this world and in the Hereafter.' 4For than is a torment in the life of this world, and certainly, harder is the tormait of the Hereafter. And they have no defender or protector against Allah.} [13:34] Therefore Allah said, ifftj iL' yfi\ ftej}

,<tf >. -V' *"-i-lv v rn smm» ~Vri 4and the torment of the Hmaft'r i\$ far ,r*r' ' ° k- '-T -- - ' vere and more lasting .} meaning: a more " >•' •»:". grievous and more painful penalty than of this world they wiU remain therein, they ^ will abide forever in *uch torme"t A "f __ ' s. Messenger ^ said to both husband and •>-/.••"? r--"r {, ' . '>' wife who took an oath, ^ when the husband accused his wife of

committing illegal sexual intercourse: <4d ^4;p-rp^)\3<Oj^ LajljSfJ! *jSUj 3r? VlijJl O'-ip j[» uup g.'iCU' «Verily, the torment of \ »'''SAk. '- •' this worldly life is more insignificant, compared \$\$, / (LxJlj^jhX to /ie punishment of the ' ^ =JI HereafterV JjV oj5 Jib j 6] rt^-* 4 i'X''' »>i (4£» 1^31*1 'f> 'fi oj>>. C& JjiS j3j ftj) o^3 J£j *• ilftJ £V-» <4^** 'ijli* Sb <jy-^ gjd* J4 £pr*j iy-: ^y 4128. Is it not a guidance for them (to know) how many generations We have destroyed before them, in whose dwellings they walk? Verily, in this are signs indeed for men of understanding.} <(129. And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined, (their punishment) Muslim 2:1131.

must necessarily have come (in this world). 4130. So bear patiently what they say, and glorify the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun, and before its setting, and during some hours of the night, and at the ends of the day, that you may become pleased with the reward which Allah shall give you.} thi Many Nations were destroyed and in Them is a Lesson Allah, the Exalted, says, ifr. 4Is it not a guidance for them...?} This is addressed to those who reject what the Prophet came to them with: *We destroyed those who denied Messengers from the previous nations before them. They showed open hostility, so now there is not trace of them none of them are left. This is witnessed by the empty home that these people left behind, and which others have not inherited, moving about in the dwellings of those of the past, 45 4 '\$} iVerily, in this are signs indeed for men of understanding.} This means those who have sound intellect and sound understanding. This is as Allah says, '''*• “i *X' ' » At *>1 A.U f > / \ j Ifr jyu jbu Lj- jyCJ <3 iw ;Ct iHave they not traveled through the land, and have they hearts where with to understand and ears where with to hear? Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} [22 :46 Allah also said in Surah Alif Lam Mtm As-Sajdah, 4Is it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they walk about?} [32 :26] Then, Allah, the Exalted, says,

410 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 3® <Sx&& jtsrLbt&> }And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined (their punishment), must necessarily have come (in this world).} [20:129] This means that if it were not for the Word that had already preceded from Allah - that He would not punish anyone until the proof had been established against him and the punishment would take place at an appointed time that He has already determined for these rejecters - then the punishment would certainly seize them immediately. The Command to be patient and perform the Five daily Prayers Allah comforts His Prophet is, by saying to him, 4So bear patiently what they say,} This means, “Be patient concerning their rejection of you.” 4And glorify the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun,} This is speaking of the Morning (Fajr) prayer. i%£ iand before its setting,} This is speaking of the Mid-afternoon (‘Asr) prayer. This has been mentioned in the Two Sahihs on the authority of Jarir bin ‘Abdullah Al-Bajali, who said, “Once we were sitting with the Messenger of Allah jfe when he looked up at the moon on a night when it was full. He said, ji j^i iojj V lx» jj'j lis Verily, you all will see your Lord (in the Hereafter) just as you see this moon and you will not have to crowd together to see Him . Therefore, if you are able to not miss a prayer before sunrise (Fajr) and before sunset (‘Asr), then you should do soJ

411 Surah 20. Ta Ha (128-130) (Part-16 Then he recited this Ayah. ”* 11 Imam Ahmad recorded that Tjmarah bin Ru'aybah that he heard the Messenger of Allah saying, jJ *Anyone who prays before

sunrise and before sunset will never enter the HellfireJ121 This was also recorded by Muslim.,3 ' Concerning Allah's statement, 4 ^ iand during some hours of the night, glorify the praises .} This means during its hours offer the late night (Tahajjud) prayer. Some of the scholars said it also means the after sunset {Maghrib) and the night ('Isha prayers. I iand at the aids of the day,} This is the opposite of the hours of the night. 4that you may become pleased} As Allah says, & Sal Jpj} 4And verily, your Lord will give you (all good) so that you shall be well-pleased.} [93:5] In the Sahlh, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, • * * • ' , # ^ ^ , * % . * , t j ' % * ^ J V j}JLJ t 4il l \ Jyi& k v^JuLL>- fyk IJj>- 1 ia.«-7 U» 1" Uc.1 Jjj ^ Hi \Tj iLj jljJ yf : y> jJoi 'JVj lilJi JJui J\ 111 Fath Al-Bari 2 :40 , Muslim 1 :439 121 Ahmad 4:136. ' Muslim 1 :440.

*Allah , the Exalted, says, "O people of Paradise." They will reply, "We are here at Your service and Your pleasure our Lord." He will then say, "Are you all pleased?" They will reply, "Why should we not be pleased our Lord, when You have given us what You have not given any others of Your creation?" Allah will then say, "Verily, I am going to give you something better than that." They will say, "And what thing could be better than that?" Allah will say, "I have allowed for you My pleasure, so I will never be angry with you again after this .""**• In another Hadith, it states that it will be said, Saja Uj ojiJZj : o_v-5 ji Jjjj <ui xj. j[JaI j&l j&j "•Syi 14JI JaiJl JA U 4)1 y tvJj «"0 people of Paradise, verily you all have an appointed promise with Allah that He would like to fulfill for you." They will say, "And what is that? Has He not already enlightened our faces, made our Scales (of good deeds) heavy, saved us from the Hellfire and entered us into Paradise?" Then, the veil will be lifted and they will gaze upon Him (Allah). By Allah, He has not given them anything better than the opportunity to look upon Him, and that is the increase (extra blessing). »< *'1 ,rV -Xu I*' '• Jf XuJ *j V-" SxA* lA> p-r-l Vjl>< u JI liCue o-u: yjf 4131 . And strain not your eyes in longing for the things We have given for enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them thereby. But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting. 4132. And enjoin Salah on your family, and be patient in offering them We take not of you a provision : We provide for you. And the good end is for those who have Taqwa 111 Path AVBQri 1)1:423. 121 Ahmad 4 :332

Do not look at the enjoyment of the wealthy, be patient in the worship of Allah. Allah, the Exalted, says to His Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ), “Do not look at what these people of luxury and their likes and peers have of nice comforts. For verily, it is only short-lived splendor and a feeble bounty, which We are using to test them with. And very few of My servants are truly thankful.” Mujahid said, “Various groups of them, ‘This means the wealthy people.’” This means, “Verily, We have given you (O Muhammad) better than that which We have given them.” This is just as Allah says in another Ayah, *And We have bestowed upon you seven repeatedly recited verses, and the Grand Qur'an. Look not with your eyes ambitiously.* [15:87-88] Likewise, that which Allah has stored for His Messenger (ﷺ) in the Hereafter is something extremely great. It is an unlimited reward that cannot be described. This is as Allah says, *And verily, your Lord will give you so that you shall be well-pleased.* [93:5] For this reason, Allah says, *But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting.* In the Sahih it is recorded that Umar bin al-Khattab entered upon the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) while he was in the small room in which he had separated himself from his wives after he had vowed to stay away from them. When he came in, he saw him (the Prophet ﷺ) lying down upon a sandy straw mat. There was

nothing in the house except a pile of sant tree pods and some hanging equipment. Umar's eyes filled with tears (upon seeing this), so the Messenger of Allah jg said to him, 111 At-Tabari 17:141.

ithat We may test them thereby. "So that We may put them to trial." Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd enjoin the Salah on your family, and be patient in offering them.} This means to save them from the punishment of Allah by the establishment of the prayer, and you also be patient in performing it. This is as Allah says, 4'jk ij j \JSC itff (\$£} iO you zoho believe! Ward off yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell).} [66:6] Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Zayd bin Aslam reported from his father that he and Yarfa' would sometimes spend the night at "Umar bin Al-Khattab's. 'Umar had a certain time of night that he would get up and pray. However, sometimes he would not get up for it. Then, we would say, "He is not going to get up like he usually does." When he would awaken, he would make his family get up as well. He would say, "And enjoin the Salah on your family, and be patient in offering themj"W Allah said; J* \ijj y} 4We ask not ofyou a provision: We providefor you.} This means that if you establish the prayer, your sustenance will come to you from where you did not expect. This is as Allah says, ot W/1 , a j J U c <0>1 fj*jf> }And whosoever has Taqwd of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out (from every difficulty). And He will provide him At-Tabari 18:405. At-Tabari 18:406.

from (sources) he never could imagine [65:2-3] Allah also says, 4 ii Styj U) &j¥ 4And I (AlldJi) created not the Jinn and mankind except that they should worship Me (Alone). until, \$&& iVerily, Allah is the All-Provider, Owner of Power, the Most Strong.> [51:56-58] Thus, Allah says, 0* Jr 4We ask not ofyou a provision : We providefor you.} Verily, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jui-i jUj ">U-i i5jJui> iJmC «Allah, the Exalted, says, "O son o/ Adam, perform My worship and 1 will fill your chest with wealth and fulfill your needs. If you do not do so, then 1 will fill your chest with toil and I will notfulfill your needs."»|1! It is also reported from Zayd bin Thabit that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, (j* gb JUj *./** *4* a i cJis y>> t A-15 otlp Jjc*-j ay>\ <J {jA t-J U 'yj uijJi -Cjij ^Whoever makes the worldly life his major concern, then Allah will scatter his situation for him (i.e. make it difficult) and his poverty will be placed between his eyes. He will not get from this world anything except that which has already been written for him. Whoever makes the Hereafter his intention, then his situation will be gathered for him (i.e. made easy) and his I 1 ' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 : 166 , Ibn Majah 2 :1376.

417Surah 20. Ta Ha (133-135) (Part-16) wealth will be placed in his heart. The worldly life will come to him anyway (in spite ofhis not seeking Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd the good end is for those ivho have Taqwa> This means the good end in this life and in the Hereafter. In the Hereafter the good end will be Paradise for whoever feared Allah. In the Sahih it is reported that the Messenger of Allah & said, jjl _lo'f lij l Ulj j lL> iilii j \j i Jt ilii j lS iilAJ lllill ^ <u>U3l jl kilJi «J saw in my dream tonight a vision as ifwe were in the home of 'Uqbah bin Rafi' and we were given fresh Ibn Tab dates. Therefore, I interpreted this dream to mean that the good final outcome ('Aqibah) is for us in this world along with lofty (Rifa'ah) positions, and that our religion is good (Tab). [21 ^ 3b i< a. jvr'li ijll) Liyjj Vj) *j' Jr* at {fr -3 Xj-y cJLj VjJ Cj .«Jj oj y'jju - -iit i,'if ' ?>«-: ? <*-';* •- ;•= -JV" O' 0>*tc— i O-JJ/J cN==* J» ,r> . J-s-> .r<0xi' 0*J 4133. They say : "Why does he not bring us a sign from his Lord?" Has there not come to them the proofof that which is in theformer papers (Scriptv-es)?} 4134. And if We had destroyed them with a torment before this, they would surely have said : "Our Lord! If only You had

sent us a Messenger, we should certainly have followed Your Ayat, before we were humiliated and disgraced 4135. Say: "Each one is waiting, so wait you too; and you shall blow who are they that are on As-Sirat As-Sawi, and ivho are they that have let themselves be guided."4 1,1 Ibn Majah 2:1375. ^ Muslim 4 : 1779 . Ibn Tab is the name of a popular kind of date

The Request of the Polytheists for Proofs while the Qur'an is itself a Proof Allah, the Exalted, informs about the disbelievers in their statement, mi \$Why does not} This means, *Why doesn't Muhammad bring us some proof from his Lord?' They meant a sign that was proof of his truthfulness in his claim that he was the Messenger of Allah. Allah, the Exalted, said, iHas there not come to them the proof of that ivhich is in the former papers (Scriptures)?} This means the Qur'an which Allah revealed to him while he was an unlettered man who could not write well and who did not study with the People of the Book. Yet, the Qur'an contains information about the people of the past that tells of their events from times long ago and it agrees with the authentic information in the previous Books concerning these matters. The Qur'an is the supervisor of these other Books. It verifies what is correct and explains the mistakes that were falsely placed in these Books and attributed to them. This Ayah is similar to Allah's statement in Surat Al-'Ankabut, El Cjj & i* i2i \$ fS 4*1 V 4 ^ I's_£=h 4And they say : "Why are not signs sent down to him from his Lord?" Say: "The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a plain wamer." It is not sufficient for them that We have sent down to you the Book which is recited to them? Verily, herein is mercy and a reminder for a people who believe.} [29:50-51] In the Two Sahths, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, jJl b\ S dp dL JU jA U olSfl p* j\ ji) I;? '-j. U>

zTiere was not any Prophet except that he was given signs that caused men to believe. That which I have been given is a revelation that Allah has revealed to me, so I hope that I have the most followers among them (the Prophets) on the Day of Resurrection .»|1 ' In this Hadith, the Prophet jfe only mentioned the greatest of the signs that he was given, which is the Qur'an. However, he did have other miracles, which were innumerable and limitless. These miracles have all been recorded in the books that discuss them, and they have been affirmed in the places that mention them. Then Allah says, \ j j)> 4And if We had destroyed them with a torment before this, they ivould surely have said : "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger..."} This means, "If We had destroyed these rejecting people before We sent this Noble Messenger to them and revealed the Mighty Book to them, they would have said, iOur Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger,} meaning, "before you destroyed us, so we could have believed in him and followed him.' This is like Allah said, ji-i J oi 4we should certainly have followed Your Aydt, before we were humiliated and disgraced.} Allah, the Exalted, explains that these rejecters are stubborn and obstinate and they will not believe. 4Even if every sign should come them, until they see the paitifid torment.} [10:97] This is as Allah says, HI Fath Al-Bari 8 :6 19 , Muslim 1 : 134

&SB&2 l&f££ 4And i/iis is a blessed Book which We have sent down, so follow it and have Taqwa (of Allah), that you may receive mercy. Until His statement, tyiT ^UtUiUbC UJ Allah also says, /**_*, */ {>vi ».-',>-> / » \ iAnd they swore by Allah their most binding oath that if a wamer came to them, they would be more guided than any of the nations (before them) . [35:42] cX-JJJ *' (ir'j% 0^ M*r iAnd they swear their strongest oaths by Allah, that if there came to them a sign, they would surely believe therein. [6: 109] to the completion of those Aydt. Then, Allah says, "Say, O Muhammad, to those who deny you, oppose you and continue in their disbelief and obstinance." iEach one is waiting,} among you

and us; 4so wait you too;} This is a command to await (anticipate). 0-* liy&- iand you shall know who are they that are on As-Sirat As- Sawi.} This means the straight road. 4*2&

4And who are they that have let themselves be guided. meaning guidance to the truth and the path of right guidance. This is similar to Allah's statement, O* 0_i£ 4And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astrayfrom the path!) [25:42] And Allah said, 4'f^Vi £ lit o 4Tomorrow they will come to know who is liar, the insolent one!) [54:26]

Surah 21: Al-Anbiya

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3587]

Opening 422 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya (Chapter - 21)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3587–3595]

The Virtues of Surat Al-Anbiya Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Yazid said that ‘Abdullah said, “Banu Israhil, Al-Kahf, Maryam, Ta Ha and Al-Anbiya’ - they are among the earliest and most beautiful Surahs and they are my treasure.”¹² In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. While they turn away in heedlessness 42. Comes not unto them an admonition from their Lord as a recent revelation but they listen to it while they play. 43. With their hearts occupied. Those who do wrong, conceal their private counsels, (saying): "Is this more than a human being like you? Will you submit to magic while you see it?" 44. He said: "My Lord knows what is said in the heavens and on earth. And He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower 111 Surah Al-Isra'. 121 Fath Al-Bari, 4 :289

45. Nay, they say: "These are mixed up false dreams! Nay, he has invented it! - Nay, he is a poet! Let him then bring us an Ayah like the ones that were sent before!" 46. Not one of the toons of those which We destroyed, believed before them; will they then believe.} The Hour is at hand but People are heedless This is a warning from Allah of the approach of the Hour, and that people are heedless of it, i.e., they are not working for it or preparing for it. An-Nasab recorded that Abu Saïd reported from the Prophet (ﷺ) that he said, "The Hour will come to pass, so seek not to hasten it" (S-4) while they turn away in heedlessness, he said, "in this world" (S-4) Allah says: "The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft asunder. And if they see a sign, they turn away." [54:1,2]. Then Allah states that they do not listen to the revelation (Wahy that He sends down to His Messenger (ﷺ), which is addressed to the Quraysh and all disbelievers like them. It means, newly-revealed, but they listen to it while they play.} This is like what Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Why do you ask the People of the Book about what they mean in Al-Kubra, 6 :407

424 Tafsir Ibn Kathir have, which has been altered and distorted, and they have added things and taken things away, when your Book is the most recently revealed from Allah, and you read it pure and unadulterated?" Al-Bukhari recorded something similar to this. 'Those who do wrong, conceal their

private counsels} meaning, what they say to one another in secret. 4Is this more than a human being like you?} meaning, the Messenger of Allah sg. They did not believe that he could be a Prophet because he was a human being like them, so how could he have been singled out to receive revelation, and not them? They said: iWill you submit to magic while you see it?} meaning, will you follow him and be like one who submits to magic when he knows that it is magic? Allah said in response to their fabrications and lies: 4 4^* f^~*: <X>3^ iHe said: "My Lord knoios what is said in the heavens and on earth..." } Nothing at all is hidden from the One Who knows that, and He is the One Who reveals this Qur'an which contains news of the earliest and last generations. No one can produce the like of this except the One Who knows all the secrets of the heavens and the earth. } And He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knoiver.} means, He hears all that they say and He knows all their circumstances. This is a warning and a threat to them. 111 Fath Al-Bari, 13:505.

425Surah 21. Al-Anbiya' (1-6) (Part-17) The Disbelievers' Ideas about the Qur'an and the Messenger their demand for a Sign and the Refutation of that ss rj6 iNay, they say: "These are mixed up false dreams! Nay, he has invented it!..." } Here Allah tells us of the stubbornness and heresy of the disbelievers, and the various things they said about the Qur'an, and how they were confused and misguided about it. Sometimes they described it as magic, and sometimes they described it as poetry, or mixed up false dreams, or a fabrication. As Allah says: 4 !VNL^ . —1»- \u LL iSee what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way } [17:48] fojljV' J-j' U£ss> /ibj 4Let him then bring us an Ayah like the ones that were sent before! } They were referring to the she-camel of Salih, and the signs of Musa and Isa. And Allah says, ioj5^1 v. J V* St'S o' L> 4And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them. } [17:59]. So Allah said here: 0* cix. 1} } Not one of the towns of those which We destroyed, believed before them; will they then believe? } None of the peoples to whom Messengers were sent were given a sign at the hands of their Prophet and believed. On the contrary, they disbelieved and We destroyed them as a result. Would these people believe in a sign if they saw it? Not at all! In fact,

_ \$J ,0j-ty, Y <^j <^&=> Ui (>* /i * J==* p-r*U jM 4-UJi iTruly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment. } [10:96-97], Indeed, they witnessed clear signs and definitive proof at the hands of the Messenger of Allah signs which were far clearer and more overwhelming than any that had been witnessed in the case of any other Prophet, may the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them all. "A -s -> . - A',' •til i- Lit ^ > 't ./ ^ ^ X v tijasj, (p L— pj_j —=OJI > Gj|»Lial>6y^=>»l)'V ^4'"- •'ill'x <" ;x ,7'^ XX . > X-X*, X .X*x d": * i i-.jU X > 'X XX^Vxv- Xx »>X-X -X*x^ .XX tp i4xil£^= V j^S o] ^soylt jil Jj3t 5s> ^ dJM C&jS ^4U 1^ ? ;v;^i gf c; ^^ cj ^ •-/- • .Lij And We sent not before you but men to whom We revealed. So ask the people of the Reminder if you do not know. } 48. And We did not place them in bodies that did not eat food, nor were they immortals. } 49. Then We fulfilled to them the promise. So We saved them and those whom We willed, but We destroyed Al-Musrifin . }

The Messengers are no more than Human Beings Here Allah refutes those who denied that human Messengers could be sent: Zrj^ CLli 4And We sent not before you but men to whom We revealed.} meaning, all the Messengers who came before you were men, human beings. There were no angels among them. This is like the Ayat tfy1 7L-j 71 Zj} 4And We sent not before you any but men unto

whom We revealed, from among the people of townships} [12:109] Si 'e-H 4Sfly: '7 aw not a nezv thing among the Messengers...} [46:9] Allah tells us that the previous nations denied that and said: it/4-4“Shall mere men guide us?”} [64:6]. So Allah says here: 4So ask the people of the Reminder if you do not ktmv.} meaning, ask the people of knowledge among the nations such as the Jews and Christians and other groups: “were the Messengers who came to you human beings or angels?” Indeed they were human beings. This is a part of the perfect blessing of Allah towards His creation: He sent to them Messengers from among themselves so that they could receive the Message from them and learn from them. 4And We did not place them in bodies that did not eat food...} meaning, rather they had bodies that ate food, as Allah says: 430a 4 oA-^J S* iXi Zf} 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets} [25:20]

428 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, they were human beings who ate and drank like all other people, and they went to the marketplaces to earn a living and engage in business; that did not affect them adversely or reduce their status in any way, as the idolators imagined. jylt VjJ jipV” J^=>t j/jf Ijci)C) ix % 4i& ji eg?^# they say ; "Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him? Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?" [25:7-8] inor were they immortals) meaning, in this world; on the contrary, they lived, then they died. £**> ^ ^ £j) iAnd We granted not to any human being immortality before you) [21:34] But what distinguished them from others was that they received revelation from Allah, and the angels brought down to them from Allah His rulings concerning His creation, what He commanded and what He prohibited. JLJiju. 'f) iTheti We fiilfilled to them the promise.) the promise that their Lord made to destroy the evildoers. Allah fulfilled His promise and did that. He says: 4So We saved them and those whom We willed,) meaning, their followers among the believers, 4but We destroyed Al-Musrifin .) meaning, those who disbelieved the Message brought by the Messengers.

&0 *csn %& * e*- 'M *© *} |J* >i] 111'C u£ dji Ua4 iJU» r i uv; gii £ia -rf^ *c 4 ^'-Uar £jp- —4-Ui cJ'j Ci 420. Indeed, We have sent down for you a Book in which there is Dhikrukum. Will you not then understand?} 411. Hoiv many a town given to wrongdoing, have We destroyed, and raised up after them another people!} 412. Then, when they sensed Our torment, behold, they (tried to) flee from it.} 413. Flee not, but return to that wherein you lived a luxurious life, and to your homes, in order that you may be questioned.} 414. They cried: "Woe to us! Certainly we have been wrongdoers."} 415. And that cry of theirs ceased not, till We made them as a field that is reaped, extinct.} The Virtue of the Qur'an Here Allah points out the noble status of the Qur'an and urges them to recognize its worth: i&>> &== XB 4Indeed, We have sent down for you a Book in which there is Dhikrukum}. Ibn 'Abbas said: "Honor for you." 4Will you not then understand?} means, will you not understand this blessing, and accept it? This is like the Ayah: opj 4And verily, this is indeed a Reminder for you and your people, and you will be questioned.} [43:44] m At-Tabari, 21:611.

How the Evildoers were destroyed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3595–3611]

j* iLL-j fZf} iHoiv many a town given to ivrongdoing, have We destroyed,} meaning, they were very many. This is like the Ayah: U i>jJ& 'fif} 4And how many generations have We destroyed after Ntlh!} Ot 4And many a toivnship did We destroy while they ivere given to ivrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins} (22:45). 4 L*j» ^ iand raised up after them another people!} means, another nation which came after them. i^ili Oi} iThen, when they sensed Our torment,} when they realized that the torment would undoubtedly come upon them, just as their Prophet had warned them, (*» 4behold, they (tried to) feefrom it.} they tried to run away. frj U j} i_ "j} 4Flee not, but return to that wherein you lived a luxurious life, and to your homes,} This is a way of ridiculing them. It will be said to them by way of ridicule: "Do not run away from the coming torment; go back to the delights and luxuries and fine homes in which you were living." Qatadah said, "Mocking them." 4in order that you may be questioned} about whether you gave thanks for what you had.

432Surah 22 . Ai-Anbiva (16-20) (Part-17) S' ei T3£ 4They cried: "Woe to us! Certainly we have been ivrong- doers."} They will confess their sins when it will be of no benefit to them. Ci*" JjSj cJ'j ^ ^ » >- ' .L 4And that cry of theirs ceased not, till We made them as a field that is reaped, extinct .} meaning, "they will keep on saying that, admitting their wrong- doing, untilWe harvest them as it were, and their movements and voices come to a stop." rJl asSSi rrr zmm <* ^ ^ S' *•*' £S S » S •^ ^ Lid UbAjOuL^ ^ ^ SCXJ —"J4^3 1U cJ 1j i'b 2' 1^1i fij^l i . ^ygjVj »i » rj' yp ojlmC ^ ,;>• / /"A^ >•> ^ *3 x > j > ": 0^ 02 «u*L bj^ ;i5-.c2j^ U-jiAi Uj , «LZJi LiU ,s >.s* **/" Zj> / "> ,',r >>'". , , -rf ~ r-' . *-.,v < ,S> U? Jiy* i5*}j j* LU ,^*-b5 J-biJ' Jf ijji J* zy^cj^* \-=> *J ^ o^So-^ V /X^ Cr*J ufJj' **6—*’ tj j4 ,Jj ,Jy^u / I ^ •!• » y // </ / •/ > i /•./«' V jtpb Jd> . ^ 426. We created not the heavens and the earth and all that is between them for play> 427. Had We intended to take a pastime. We cohM surely have taken itfrom Us, ifWe were going to do (that).} 418. Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it disappears. And woe to you for that which you ascribe.}

419. To Him belongs whosoever is in the heavens and on earth. And those who are near Him are not too proud to worship Him, nor are they weary. 420. They glorify His praises night and day, they never slacken.} Creationwas made with Justice andWisdom Allah tells us that He created the heavens and the earth in truth, i.e. with justice. 4that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those zuho do good, with what is best.} [53:31]. He did not create all that in vain or for (mere) play: 01 !>j& U& jij* ^ Cj J'jii itZli QIC £j} 4i\$J# 4And We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelievfrom the Fire!} [38:27] 4\ vi{^t» 0) (Li Of OiieV jgjs o' TL\$ \$) 4Had We intended to take a pastime, We could surely have taken itfrom Us, ifWe were going to do (that).} Ibn Abi Najlh said, narrating from Mujahid: 4 (Li oi (fr o"i y} 4Had We intended to take a pastime. We could surely have taken itfrom Us,} "Meaning, 'From Ourselves,' He is saying, *We would not have created Paradise or Hell or death or the resurrection or the Reckoning.”11 Af-Tabari, 18:421.

433Surah 21. Al-Anbiya' (16-20) (Part-17 4if We were going to do (that).} Qatadah, ' As-Suddi, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i and Mughlrah bin Miqsam said: "This means, We will not do that." Mujahid said, every time the word 4if} is used in the Qur'an, it is a negation. 121 4^f)' £ 4Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood,} means, *We explain the truth and thus defeat falsehood.' Allah says: 4%v>£% iso it destroys it, and behold, it disappears.} it is fading and vanishing. 4And woe to you} O you who

say that Allah has offspring. 4Jlloo £*} 4for that which you ascribe.} that which you say and fabricate. Then Allah informs of the servitude of the angels, and how they persevere in worship night and day: Everything belongs to Allah and serves Him i > r •" «. .trr- J o* Ajf 4To Him belongs whosoever is in the heavens and on earth. And those who are near Him} i.e., the angels. 4-itM o* ^4 iare not too proud to worship Him,} they do not feel proud and do not refuse to worship Him. This is like the Ayah At-Jabari, 18:420. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur, 5:620.

iAl-Masili will never be proud to reject being a servant of Allah, nor the angels who are the near. And ivlisoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} [4:172] inor are they weary.} means, they do not get tired or feel bored. 4'^xfju_ V jlpb Jji iThey glorify His praises night and day, they never slacken .} They persist in their worship night and day, obeying Allah to the utmost, and they are able to do this, as Allah says: \j> jjCiuj £ iif v> iwho do not disobey Allah in ivhat He commands them, but do what they are commanded [66:6] ££ foj & 4[hy. £*, j) ^ &h 421 . Or have they taken (for worship) gods from the earth who raise the dead?} 422. Had there been therein (in the heavens and the earth) gods besides Allah, then verily, both would have been ruined. Glorified be Allah, the Lord of the Throne, (High is He) above all that (evil) they associate with Him!} 423. He cannot be questioned as to what He does, while they will be questioned.} Refutation of false gods Allah denounces those who take other gods instead of Him: 4 jfjil Jt i*!'* \>jJil ff} 40r have they taken godsfrom the earth who raise the dead?} meaning, can they bring the dead back to life and bring them forth from the earth? They cannot do any of that, so how can they make them rivals to Allah and worship them alongside Him? Then Allah tells us that if there were another god besides Him,

435Surah 21. Al-Anbiyd' (21-23) (Part-17) the heavens and the earth would be ruined: tifj ck \$} 4Had there been therein gods} means, in the heavens and the earth, itthen verily, both would have been ruined.} This is like the Ayah: (*+***; vjll. U_i jjJi Jt A" l*j -d> Oi «>' 4 iV > U-e ja*> Je 4No son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along with Him Then each god tvould have taken away ivhat he had created, and some would have tried to overcome others! Glorified be Allah aborve all that they attribute to Him!} [23:91], And Allah says here: 1' > . ' ?•' . "u •' i; XU jy!' yj *lll iGlorified be Allah, the Lord of the Throne, above all that they associate with Him!} meaning, glorified be He above what they say about Him having offspring or partners; glorified and exalted and sanctified be He far above all the lies that they fabricate. 4 , jli u- jll; 4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} He is the Ruler Whose rule cannot be overturned and none can object to it, because of His might, majesty, pride, knowledge, wisdom, justice and subtlety. iwhile they will be questioned.} means, He is the One Who will ask His creation about what they did. This is like the Ayah: ;4&£S 4So, by your Lord, I'Ve shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} [15:92-93] its aa.% *4.

4And He protects (all), white against Whom there is no protector} [23:88] o* j* £% 'ji j&S. !>'> j* *A* j* \jX^ £} y J3 \$3i Cfj c>t -^4j oj Ci-jjJ Cj^ i*+» J. -/>> .. •* >-rr tf it. 'j. ^24. Or have they taken for worship gods besides Him? Say: "Bring your proof. This is the Reminderfor those with me and the Reminder for those before me." But most of them know not the Truth, so they are averse.} 425. And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying): "There is no God but I, so worship Me."} 40r have they taken for worship gods besides Him? Say:} - O Muhammad - 4Bring your

proof.} your evidence for what you Eire saying. 4This is the Reminderfor those with me} means, the Qur'an. <y 4and the Reminder for those before me} means, the previous Books, unlike what you claim. Each Book was revealed to each Prophet who was sent with the message that there is no god except Allah, but you idolators do not recognize the truth, so you turn away from it. Allah says: 4 1'K "0 VI -dl V 'A A\ 4And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "There is no god but I..."}

438 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 427 . They speak not until He has spoken, and they act on His command.} 428. He knoius ivhat is before them, and what is behind them, and they cannot intercede except for him ivith whom He is pleased. And they stand in aweforfear ofHim. 429. And if any of Hum should say: "Verily , I am a god besides Him," such We should recompense xoith Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers. The Refutation ofThose Who claim that the Angels are the Daughters of Allah; description of their Deeds and Status Here Allah refutes those who claim that He has offspring among the angels - exalted and sanctified be He. Some of the Arabs believed that the angels were the daughters of Allah, but Allah says: s#s •.tu, t 4Glory to Him! They are but honored servants. meaning, the angels are servants of Allah who are honored by Him and who hold high positions of noble status. They obey Him to the utmost in all their words and deeds. 4They speak not until He has spoken, and they act on His command.} meaning, they do not initiate any matter before Him or go against His commands; on the contrary, they hasten to do as He commands, and He encompasses them with His knowledge so that nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. lij J '&> £ {&.> 4He knows what is before them, and what is behind them,} 4and they cannot intercede except for him xoith xvhom He is pleased.} This is like the Ayat.

4'fity. i»X* jiis ijjSi li &*> <\$W7io is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} [2:255) 0 ^ intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits [34:23]. There are many Ayat which say similar things. 4-&U- Ik iAnd theyforfear ofHim} means, because ik cy] (*-ri <P; i>*j .'V they fear Him. < i i . 'f iAnd they stand in awe. And if any of them should say : "Verily, Iam a god besides Him,") meaning, whoever claims to be a god instead of Allah, i.e., alongside Allah, 4smc/i We should recompense with Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers.} meaning, everyone who says this. This is a conditional sentence, and the condition stated does not necessarily have to take place. This is like the Ayat 4> & *1 iSay: "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of worshippers."} [43:81] is &ssj ai? 2=3& \$} ilf you join others in worship with Allah, (then) surely, (all) your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers.} [39:65]

4 ^ - k--Lv >v { l} iX o * L? jlpjj J2' 430. Have not those who disbelieve known that the heavens and the earth were joined together as one united piece, then We parted them? And We have made from water every living thing. Will they not then believe?} 432 . And We have placed on the earth firm mountains, lest it should shake with them, and We placed therein broad highways for them to pass through, that they may be guided.} 432. And We have made the heaven a roof, safe and well- guarded. Yet they turn awayfrom its signs}. 433. And He it is Who has created the night and the day, and the sun and the moon, each in an orbitfloating.} The Signs ofAllah in the Heavens and the Earth and in the Night and the Day Here Allah tells of His perfect might and power in His creation and subjugation of all things. &4 iHave not those who disbelieve knotvn} means, those who deny His Divine nature and

worship others instead of Him, do they not realize that Allah is the One Who is Independent in His powers of creation and is running the affairs of all things with absolute power? So how can it be appropriate to worship anything else beside Him or to associate others in worship with Him? Do they not see that the heavens and the earth were joined together, i.e. in the beginning they were all one piece, attached to one another and piled up on top of one another, then He separated them from one another, and made the heavens seven and the earth seven, placing the air between the earth and the lowest heaven. Then He caused rain to fall from the sky and vegetation to grow from the earth. He says: i'oUy. Sj O^rj} iAnd We have made from water every living thing. Will they not then believe?}

441Surah 21. Al-Anbiua' (30-33) (Part-17) meaning, they see with their own eyes how creation develops step by step. All of that is proof of the existence of the Creator Who is in control of all things and is able to do whatever He wills. In everything there is a Sign ofHim, showing thatHe is One. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from his father from 'Ikrimah that Ibn 'Abbas was asked; "Did the night come first or the day?" He said, "Do you think that when the heavens and the earth were joined together, there was anything between them except darkness? Thus you may know that the night came before the day."111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn TJmar said that a man came to him and questioned him about when the heavens and earth were joined together then they were parted. He said, "Go to that old man (Shaykh) and ask him, then come and tell me what he says to you." So he went to Ibn 'Abbas and asked him. Ibn 'Abbas said: "Yes, the heavens were joined together and it did not rain, and the earth was joined together and nothing grew. When living beings were created to populate the earth, rain came forth from the heavens and vegetation came forth from the earth." The man went back to Ibn TJmar and told him what had been said. Ibn TJmar said, "Now I know that Ibn 'Abbas has been given knowledge of the Qur'an. He has spoken the truth, and this is how it was." Ibn TJmar said: "I did not like the daring attitude of Ibn 'Abbas in his Tafsir of the Qur'an, but now I know that he has been given knowledge of the Qur'an."21 Said bin Jubayr said: "The heavens and the earth were attached to one another, then when the heavens were raised up, the earth became separate from them, and this is their parting which was mentioned by Allah in His Book." Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, "They were joined together, then they were separated by this air." J- tCs' 111 At-Tabari, 18:433. ' Ibn Abi Hatim , 8 :2450

iAnd We have made from water every living thing> meaning, the origin ofevery living thing is in water. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "I said: O Messenger of Allah, when I see you I feel happy and content, tell me about everything." He sg said, 'if* ji& «Everything was createdfrom water. "I said, tell me about something which, if I do it, I will enter Paradise." He jg said: I*- 'fQ J-fj 2>jl j4ol 4Spread (the greeting of) Salam, feed others, uphold the ties of kinship, and stand in prayer at night when people are sleeping. Then you will enter Paradise in peace . (1) This chain of narration fulfills the conditions of the Two \$afyihs, apart from Abu Maymunah, who is one of the men of the Sunans, his first name was Salim; and At-Tirmidhi classed him as Sahih. 4And We have placed on the earthfirm mountains means, mountains which stabilize the earth and keep it steady and lend it weight, lest it should shake with the people, i.e., move and tremble so that they would not be able to stand firm on it - because it is covered with water, apart from one- quarter of its surface. So the land is exposed to the air and sun, so that its people may see the sky with its dazzling signs and evidence. So Allah says, ilest it should shake ivith them,? meaning, so that it will not shake with them. 4^ 4and We placed therein broad highways for them to pass m Ahmad , 2 :295 , 323 , 324

443 Surah 21 . Al-Anbiud' (30-33) (Part-17 through,) means, mountain passes through which they may travel from region to region, country to country. As we can see, the mountains form barriers between one land and another, so Allah created gaps - passes - in the mountains so that people may travel from here to there. So He says: 4that they may be guided.} 1 Lii— tiMrf} iAnd We have made the heaven a roof, safe and loell-guarded.} means, covering the earth like a dome above it. This is like the Ayah, • *. V Ajtj l .1; 4With Hands We constructed the heaven. Verily, We are able to extend the vastness ofspace thereof.} [51:47] = cij 4By the heaven and Him Who built it.} [91:5] 4, ? (pj Jt (i&j •SS' XjS\ j'. 'jjJt 4Have they not looked at the heaven above them, hoiu We have made it and adorned it, and there are no rifts in it?) [50:6]. The building and making described here refers to the raising of the dome, as when the Messenger of Allah said, *Islam is built on five, n11 ' i.e., five pillars, which can only refer to a tent as familiar among the Arabs. ill*#} 4safe and well-guarded.} means, high and protected from anything reaching it. Mujahid said, "Raised up." m Fath Al-Bari, 1 :64. 121 At-Tabari, 18:436.

ref* Cfy* cf iYet they him awayfrom its signs.} This is like the Ayah: (C-S> Oii^; ufjV'j j /j'» oi lio» many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom} [12:105]. They do not think about how Allah has created it, so vast and high, and adorned it with heavenly bodies both stationary and moving by night and day, such as the sun which completes its circuit in one day and night, until it completes its allotted time, which no one knows except Allah, Who created it and subjugated it and directed its course. Then Allah says, drawing attention to some of His signs, / y ^ "*" 4* /// <4 /y, ij&j 6^- fj} iAnd He it is Who has created the night and the day,} meaning, the one with its darkness and stillness, and the other with its light and human interaction; sometimes the one is longer while the other is shorter, then they switch. iand the sun and the moon,} the sun with its own light and its own path and orbit and allotted time, and the moon which shines with a different light and travels on a different path and has its own allotted time. ieach in an orbit floating.} means, revolving. Ibn 'Abbas said, "They revolve like a spinning wheel, in a circle."111 This is like theAyah i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing.} At-Tabari, 20:520 , 521

445 Surah 21 . Al-Anbiud' (34-35) (Part-17) (6:96] * "t! * < 7- jt-fi C-j jJiJ' iji t>j^ £)t'. ili jJsiT. 'M 434. And We granted not to any human being immortality before you; then ifyou die, would they liveforever?} 435. Everyone is going to taste death, and We shall test you with evil and with good by way of trial. And to Us you will be returned.} No One hasbeen granted Immortality in this World &»- 4And We granted not to any human being immortality before you;} means, O Muhammad. 4%S\} 4immortality means, in this world. On the contrary, 4Whatsoever is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and honor will remain forever.} [55:26-27]. 6\$} 4then ifyou die} means, O Muhammad, 4ojJtoLi ^£} 4would they live forever?} means, they hope that they will live forever after you, but that will not happen; everything will pass away. So Allah says: o^ 4Everyone is going to taste death,} 4&i J&, } 4and We shall test you with evil and with good by way of trial.}

Meaning, "We shall test you, sometimes with difficulties and sometimes with ease, to see who will give thanks and who will be ungrateful, who will have patience and who will despair." 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas: iand We shall test you} means, We will test you, i*^i JI\> iwith evil and with good by way of trial.} means, with difficulties and with times of prosperity, with health and sickness,

with richness and poverty, with lawful and unlawful, obedience and sin, with guidance and misguidance. iAnd to Us you will be returned.} means, and We will requite you according to your deeds. (^+11* !i£» vi ٓi Sji -iJ'v /f .V" A* » > 'r,? " > ' •> • Jk 436. And when those who disbelieved see you, they take you not except for mockery (saying) : "Is this the one who talks about your gods?" While they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious.} 437. Man is created of haste. I will show you My Ayat. So ask Me not to hasten (them).}

How the Idolators mocked the Prophet^

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3611–3652]

Allah tells His Prophet jg: }And when those who disbelieved see you,} meaning, the disbelievers of the Quraysh, such as Abu Jahl and his like. 4u>-» vi ^i£ m At-Tabari , 18 :440

447Surah 21. Al-Anbiua' (36-37) (Part-17 ithey take you not exceptfor mockery} means, they make fun ofyou and insult you, saying, i"Is this the one who talks about your gods?"} meaning, is this the one who insults your gods and ridicules your intelligence? Allah says: £0MiM iWhile they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious.} meaning, they disbelieve in Allah and yet they mock the Messenger of Allah jg. As Allah says: £ GUj o\ ii'^ vi 4 iiJ<0 itgpuf.&£^ ^ jJjg, <3% \4& iAnd when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger? He would have nearly misled usfrom our gods, had it not been that we were patient and constant in their worship!" And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astrayfrom the path!} [25:41-42] i)fd It i+rff&} iMati is created of haste.} This is like the Ayah: iy.fy 'M iand man is ever hasty} [17:11], in all matters. The reason why the haste of man is mentioned here is that when mention is made of those who mock the Messenger jg, (the believers) will want to avenge them swiftly, and that so should happen sooner. Allah says, if** i>t &¥ \$Man is created of haste.} because He delays (the punishment) until a time when, once He seizes him, He will never let him go. He delays it, then He hastens it; He waits, then He does not delay any longer. So He says:

449Surah 21. Al-Anbiud' (38-40) (Part-17) 4Atid they say: "When will this promise (come to pass), ifyou are truthful".} And Allah says o* "£> V oj->- S;i* jUj“ 4If only those who disbelieved knew (the time) when they will not be able to ward off the Firefrom their faces, norfrom their backs,} meaning, if only they knew for certain that it will inevitably come to pass, they would not seek to hasten it. If only they knew how the torment will overwhelm them from above them and from beneath their feet. 'rfZ ,yj jl5l> ft ^ £ fi} iThey shall have coverings of Fire, above them and coverings (ofFire) beneath them [39:16] w * t>. S . »| r** toe iTheirs ivill be a bed ofHell (Fire), and over them coverings (of Hellfire)} [7:41], And in this Ayah Allah says: ft. V f=-r} iwheti they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, norfrom their backs,} And Allah says: iTheir garments will be of tar, and fire will cover their faces} [14:50]. The torment will surround them on all sides, 4and they will not be helped.} means, and they will have no helper. This is like the Ayah 4And they have no guardian against Allah} [13:34]. (*+-& 4Nay, it will come upon thetn all ofa sudden} means, the Fire will

& ii'C jaj 4 Verily, Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt ; till Our help reached than, and none can alter the Words ofAllah. Surely, there has reached

you the information (news) about the Messengers (before you)) [6:34]. Then Allah mentions His favor for His creatures; He protects them by night and by day, taking care of them and watching over them with His Eye that never sleeps. UM £ fo iSay : "Wlw can guard and protect you in the night or it} the dayfrom the Most Gracious?"} means, other than the Most Gracious Himself? jL i *! »' > . ' • * I'V>^JJ 0* JiT iNay, but they turn away from the remembrance of their Lord.} means, they do not recognize the blessings and favor of Allah towards them; they turn away from His signs and blessings. iOr have they gods wlw can guard themfrom Us?} This is a rhetorical question aimed at denouncing and rebuking. The meaning is, do they have any gods who can protect them and take care of them other than Us? It is not as they imagine or as they claim. Allah says: 4 y} }They have no power to help themselves,} these gods on whom they rely instead of Allah cannot even help themselves. iL; inor can they be protected from Us.} Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "Nor can they be guarded from Us."111 hi At-Tabari, 18:448.

453 Surah 21. Al-Anbiyd' (44-47) (Part-17) Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: "This means the victory of Islam over disbelief." 1 11 The meaning is: Do they not learn a lesson from the fact that Allah supported those (believers) against their enemies, He destroyed the disbelieving nations and the evil- doing townships, and He saved His believing servants? So Allah says: ils it then they who will overcome?} meaning, on the contrary, they are the ones who will be overcome, who will be defeated, humiliated and brought low. iSay : "I warn you only by the revelation meaning, 'I only convey to you the warning of Allah's punishment and vengeance, and this is no more than that which Allah reveals to me.' But this is of no benefit to the one whom Allah has made blind and has put a seal over his hearing and his heart. He says: C 'jeJU' 4But the deaf will not hear the call, (even) when they are warned . 4And if a breath of the torment of your Lord touches them, they will surely, cry: "Woe unto us! Indeed we have been wrongdoers!"} If these disbelievers were affected by the slightest touch of Allah's punishment, they would confess their sins and admit that they had wronged themselves in this world. JLi) jtLlu Vi li.*-j)t iigjjJill 4And We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything.} meaning, "We shall set up the Balances of justice on the Day li) A(-Tabari, 1 :494.

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir of Resurrection." The majority of scholars state that it is one Balance, and the plural form is used here to reflect the large number of deeds which will be weighed therein. Jij>- oi of) Jlii (ti-bS ^5^ 4then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed, We ivill bring it. And sufficient are We to take account. This is like the Ayat 4Q 4: 'Jk Sij> iand your Lord treats no one with injustice> [18:49] 4;;J;tL^ ii'i iSurely, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of speck of dust, but if there is any good. He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward. [4:40] Jfj'A j A j j' f-e- d\j£t. til" 4 .?', «<iA Ol 4"0 my son! If it be equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well- Aware."^ [31:16] In the Two SahXhs it was recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said: JI jliLiJ i jLJtl f U Q jlills'® p ;laW^ *ji I fcoJu^>uj «1>I "Two words which are light on the tongue, heavy in the Balance and beloved to Ar-Rahman: "Subhdn Alldhi wa bi hamdihi, Subhdn Alldhil 'Azmi (Glory and praise be to Allah, Glory be to Allah the Almighty)."^ Fat* Al-Bari, 13:547; Muslim, 4:2072.

Imam Ahmad also recorded that ‘A’ishah said that one of the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ج sat down before him and said, “O Messenger of Allah, I have two slaves who lie to me, betray me and disobey me, and I hit them and insult them. How do I stand with regard to them?” The Messenger of Allah ج said: $\text{ججل كلتلف جس' جف ف جلس «للفلف- جلس جف ف دللف- 'فج <لف ج ففس جلف {جف ^جفل <فك* {ك4$ فف ففج* جلف جلف ج فلف جف} \text{“The extent to which they betrayed you, disobeyed you and lied to you will be measured against the punishment you meted out to them. If your punishment was commensurate with their misconduct, then you will be equal and you will not have anything counted for you or against you. If your punishment of them was less than that what they deserved for their misconduct, then this will count in your favor. If your punishment of them was more than what they deserved for their misconduct, then Allah will take what is due to them from you.} \text{» Then the man started to weep before the Messenger of Allah ج, and the Messenger of Allah ج asked, جفلف فف ل'فلف' ^فج^4ف \فف > ف افف» جفف} \text{«What is the matter with him? Has he not read the words of Allah, اففد We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed. We will bring it. And sufficient are We to take account.} \text{? The man said, “O Messenger of Allah, I think there is nothing better than keeping away from these people - meaning his slaves - I call upon you to bear witness that they are all free.”} \text{111 111 Ahmad, 4:280.}$

* <f; ^ eFC JSj> JJ JijC;^u& jffi? jyj pij wiliC ^4S. And indeed We granted to Musa and Harun the criterion, and a shining light and a Reminder for those who have Taqwa.) 449. Those who fear their Lord in the unseen, and they are afraid of the Hour.) 450. And this is a blessed Reminder which We have sent down; will you then deny it?) The Revelation of the Tawrah and the Qur’an We have already noted that Allah often mentions Musa and Muhammad together - may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon them both - and He often mentions their Books together as well. He says: اففف& ojJLli) (>جف لفف* ف) 4And indeed We granted to Musa and Harun the criterion Mujahid said, “This means the Scripture.”111 Abu Salih said: “The Tawrah.” Qatadah said: “The Tawrah, what it permits and it forbids, and how Allah differentiated between truth and falsehood.”121 In conclusion, we may say that the heavenly Books included the distinction between truth and falsehood, guidance and misguidance, transgression and the right way, lawful and unlawful, and that which will fill the heart with light, guidance, fear of Allah and repentance. So Allah says: 4^4% {ف% vL& 'd&K) 4the criterion, and a shining light and a Reminder for those who have Taqwa.) meaning, a reminder and exhortation for them. Then He describes them as: 4Those who fear their Lord in the unseen.) This is like the Ayah: At-Tabari, 18:453. At-Tabari, 18:453.

457Surah 21. Al-Anbiya' (51-56) (Part-17) &rJ X) / sc- ف^ف فWfxo feared the Most Gracious in the unseen and came forth with a repent- ing hearty [50:33] >w.. *)ل? Oj * • -_ {جJAS ف:* °4 5& A فVerily, those who fear their Lord unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.) [67:12] and they are afraid of the Hour.) means, they fear it. Then Allah says: ففO% فAnd this is a blessed Reminder which We have sent down;) means, the Magnificent Qur’an, which falsehood cannot approach, from before it or behind it, revealed by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. mmm V,Jj agtfHyT rrT / -V ^ _> *> "C > > , *> <*' <" OjJj@ @ ^=s />>, "S.-Wt' >" " > ف * -t" GSjJJ •a ^ 5^0 جUs—جفJo جس .a&j <*' ' S لf » TC" ##4{جap جJibj <&f/> 4wif// فow then deny it?) means, will you deny it when it is the utmost in clarity and truth? <جCa ل* ,.^ *A^ ^ p -Ub جسف جU "fe^xfc- Q UU'ف كجuf فج!U 'Vr فف 4*ج]??ج ج: جff C^osj>dl' of جJ ^ *ف#

'IsS'pJs* ^a-> 4 f^=5Mt) ^ jj _£j'i c? \$5 tfXX* JfXb y>“ 451 . And indeed We bestowed aforetime on Ibrahim his

guidance, and We were Well-Acquainted with him.} <52. When he said to his father and his people: "What are these images to which you are devoted?"} <53. They said: "We found our fathers worshipping them."} <54. He said: "Indeed you and your fathers have been in manifest error."} <55. They said: "Have you brought us the Truth, or are you one of those who play about?"} <56. He said: "Nay, your Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, Who created them and to that I am one of the witnesses."} The Story of Ibrahim and his People Allah tells us about His close Friend Ibrahim, peace be upon him, and how He bestowed upon him guidance aforetime, i.e., from an early age He inspired him with truth and evidence against his people, as Allah says elsewhere: iAnd that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people} [6:83]. The point here is that Allah is telling us that He gave guidance to Ibrahim aforetime, i.e., He had already guided him at an early age. <oui^ &'} iand We were Well-Acquainted with him.} means, and he was worthy of that. Then Allah says: iWhen he said to his father and his people: "What are these images, to which you are devoted?"} This is the guidance which he had been given during his youth: his denunciation of his people's worship of idols instead of Allah. Ibrahim said: <oJ££- 01 -ff '1 (>} 4"What are these images, to which you are devoted?"} meaning, which you worship with such devotion.

^ \Luj »j)U^ iThey said: "We found our fathers worshipping them."} means, they had no other evidence apart from the misguided actions of their forefathers. Ibrahim said: 4yJ p&o& 'P 4Indeed you and your fathers have been in manifest error.} meaning, Speaking to your fathers whose actions you cite as evidence would be the same as speaking to you. Both you and they are misguided and are not following any straight path.' When he called their intelligence into question, and said that their fathers were misguided and belittled their gods. iThey said: "Have you brought us the Truth, or are you one of those who play about?"} They said: These words that you are saying, are you speaking in jest or are you telling the truth? For we have never heard such a thing before.' i&fr jf&jp& S. js» 4He said: "Nay, your Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth. Who created them..."} meaning, your Lord, beside Whom there is no other god, is the One Who created the heavens and the earth and all that they contain; He 'is the One Who initiated their creation; He is the Creator of all things. iand to that I am one of the witnesses.} means, and I bear witness that there is no God other than Him and no Lord except Him. vj xs S JM&& S |» Jytl yl» (Jij

1e6:£e] ipuvif lifiu (sty) ifftm (tuaiff) SupjLqs 'mail} uodn pauutf atf uaqi 'i/dfiy atp aipj si stqx 'lopi } sa33iq aqj jo jdaaxa 'pe uiaq; paqseuis aq 'stream ^'s333td Of utaiff aqouq 3i{ osP <r^rrr •unq preaq peq ajdoad atp jo auios pire i'sqavq mod. patutif puo dvmv auo8 3(ion nod J3)/u sfopt mod aoj uvjd v fo\d //m/s / 'i{Vffiy dq puy\$ 4%f psfZ f tf\ 5*3® 'piBs peq aq psqj ajojaq /Cep aqj Xjuo sbm jj ,, , -qois ure j, 'pres an ,<isn qjiM jno 3uiuia jou noX are 'unqBjqj q, 'pres ptre unq dq passed jfoqi '[BATjsaj Jiaqj ajejqapo o} jno jua/a unqBjqj jo aidoad aqj uaq^, '[po,sepi uqi] qBqnpqv, uiojj SBMqv -IV nqy moaj pajjodaj beqsi nqy -ajBjqapa oj jno o§ p/no/a Xaqj qotq/a jBATjsaj b peq Xaqx [BApsaj Jiaqj oj jno iusm Aaqj uaqM 'sqaBq jiaqj paturq ptre de/toa auo3 pBq Xaqj jaye tuaqj yCojjsap ptre tuaqj qeajq oj '-a-i 's/opi Jiaqj jsureSe jojd oj 'preaq aidoad siq jo auios qaiq/a 'qjBO ire 3joms unqeqji uaqx sjopi aqq difoiq unqeqjmqmoh i'/fivads two dmp Ji 'utaiff dsV V PfP tuaiff Jo fsaSSiq aiff '3110 stiff 'dv^, '-

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461Surah 21. Al-Anbim' (57-63) (Part-17 *k 4that they might turn to it.) It was said that he put a hammer in the hands of the biggest idol so that the people would think that it had become jealous on its own account and objected to these smaller idols being worshipped alongside it, so it had broken them. iThey said: "Who has done this to our gods? He must indeed be one of the wrongdoers."} When they came back and saw what Ibrahim had done to their idols, humiliating them and lowering their status, proving that they were not divine and that those who worshipped them were fools. iThey said: "Who has done this to our gods? He must indeed be one of the wrongdoers."} because of this action of his. iThey said: "We heard a young man talking against than, who is called Ibrahim."} Those who had heard him swearing to plot against them said, we heard a young man talking about them, and they said that he was called Ibrahim. 4' £3 -ti *y'b yii» iThey said: "Then bring him before the eyes of the people..."} meaning, in front of a large audience so that all the people could be present. This was Ibrahim's ultimate purpose, so that he could tell this great gathering about the extent of their ignorance and how foolish they were to worship idols which could not defend themselves from harm or help themselves, so how could they ask them for help? S ju CM ill lli S3: iThey said : "Are you the one who has done this to our gods.

O Ibrahim?" He said: "Nay, this one, the biggest of them did it..." referring to the one he had left alone and had not broken. iAsk them, if they can speak!) He was hoping that they would admit of their own volition that these idols could not speak and that this idol would not say anything because it was inanimate. In the Two Sahihs it was recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger ofAllah jg said: 1 ' 4""^ ijt Or-i j~i- u'ISO <oli)l kSj. jl •Ibrahim , upon him be peace, did not tell lies except on three occasions, twofor the sake ofAllah - when he said : iNay, this one, the biggest ofthem did it.) and when he said: ipf i!> iVerily, I am sick) [37:89]. Vji* Jy itjU. y, l]Zj : Jli 'b -4 ' *** ij^rj ^4* Jy -i* : Jlii jJ-j . jli . I . J li 31^XJl ;Jia li : Jlii t 3l><i aJlI 'ce>5 4\$ ^3J^ '4^ 3i 3^' 14* 01 : Jtii IjL. JI JLili t J; (*4—* ^13 'jil tj? 4^ '«x* 'ili . UTy Jp cisij jl llii fli jU jL-*'3i] 1& JLili J-jli nJ c^4i ' ^3-^ ^3 J 4il j^pjl : Jlii iljjjJi Ijblf .Lj.(i ijJlia Jia J-ii 4>-(i iSJUl 41JS jio i.xJ»l jl l^lljj JUj-fi ijJlia i l^lll ^jjjili ^ ^ 4 4-p.ii 2i' ^il : Jlii ioUa-,w L jJ tijJl ; Jlii Cr? <_r*^ *•oLili oJlai-fj o>-^>-ti . ^ :cJli : Jlij iOU»

463Surah 21 . Al-Anbiua (64-67) (Part-17) «and when he was traveling in the land of one of the tyrants, and Sarah was with him; when he made camp, a man came to the tyrant and said, "A man has made camp in your land and with him is a woman who is the most beautiful ofpeople." The tyrant sent for Ibrahim, and asked him, "Wltat is the relationship of this woman to you?" He said, "She is my sister." The tyrant said, "Go and send her to me." So Ibrahim went to Sarah and said, "Tins tyrant asked me about you, and I told him that you are my sister, so do not let him think that J am lying. For you are indeed my sister according to the Book of Allah, and there are no Muslims on the earth apart from you and I." So Ibrdltlm brought her to him, then he stood and prayed. When she entered upon the tyrant, he

reached for her desirously once he saw her. But he suffered a severe seizure. So, he said, "Pray to Allah for me and I will not harm you." So she prayed for him and it released him. Then he reached for her desirously, but he was stricken similarly before or worse. This continued three times, and each time he said the same as he had said the first time. Then he called the closest of his guards and said, "You have not brought me a human being, you have brought me a devil! Take her out and give her Hajar. So she was taken out and given Hajar, and she went back. When Ibrahim realized that she had come back, he finished his prayer and turned around. He said, "What happened?" She said, "Allah took care of the evil disbeliever's plot, and he gave me Hajar as a servant." Muhammad bin Sirin said, "When Abu Hurayrah narrated this Hadith, he said, This is your mother, O sons of the water of the heaven." > 1 > cfa& jSj j. *-j fa' ^ f ^ , ..j*; H h| jfa jjiUi J [fa*r %& faZ. * t ^«*4\$ 3d 3# u' Sui fa o/i oi QS0^ 464. So they turned to themselves and said: "Verily you are the wrongdoers." } m Fath Al-Bari, 6 :447 ; Muslim , 4 -.1840

465 Surah 21. Al-Anbiy' (68-70) (Part-17) rrv Cjp f|p *4j\yUyIs i^JJ (S*Ao^r-[>AIs i&2&juc| Ijli JvJ *—£/. di'^0^Ki>I^ui,U.;j*3Ui <./**> ** ^ > i ^ -1'.*^ . ' ' •'/. » >> Jlli ^Vi ^"- Jj« k- ^VJ-laU. -.Jf- Aa' —Jjjj '1 *vaji — "r , ^ *itr^ij »j^>- \$<^>J^ U&0 Ciz\$ J^Tjili)j ' < " -t•";' i ^ t-}o_J 4j3li ^Sf©t3© meaning, if they can- not speak and they can neither benefit you nor harm you, then why do you worship them instead of Allah? &, oj £i . ^ / ^ TAoy'i*' "5L*' «J»' jjj <Fie upon you, and upon that which you worship besides Allah! Have you then no sense?} 'Do you not realize the extent of the misguidance and extreme disbelief which you are following, which no one could accept but one who is an ignorant and evil wrong-doer?' He defeated them in argument and left them with no way out. Allah said: y d* &>}} i And that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people [6:83] <v <///•/ J * V . / / St*. , / > > *^v' »-• i « >> , / '-'./x Jjc- Lli—J o/ u) *£/»“ 4(^> 4r-iV' -ii '-f',j~£)\ 468. They said: "Burn him and help your gods, if you will be doing." } 469. We said: "O fire! Be you cool and safety for Ibrahim!" } 470. And they wanted to harm him, but We made them the worst losers. }

466 Tafstr Ibn Kathir How Ibrahim was thrown into the Fire and how Allah controlled it When their arguments were refuted and their incapability became clear, when truth was made manifest and falsehood was defeated, they resorted to using their power and strength, and said: i"Burn him and help your gods, if you will be doing." } So they gathered together a huge amount*of wood. As-Suddi said, "I if a woman was sick, she would make a vow that if she recovered she would bring wood to burn Ibrahim. Then they made a hole in the ground and set it aflame, and it burned with huge sparks and immense flames. There had never been a fire like it. They put Ibrahim, peace be upon him, into a catapult, at the suggestion of a nomadic Kurdish than from Persia." 111 Shu'ayb Al-Jaba'i said, "His name was Hayzan, and Allah caused the earth to swallow him up, and he will remain sinking into it until the Day of Resurrection. When they threw him he said, 'Sufficient for me is Allah, and He is the best disposer of affairs.' " 121 This is similar to what Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that Ibrahim said, "Sufficient for me is Allah, and He is the best disposer of affairs," when he was thrown into the fire, and Muhammad jg said it when they said: iVerily, the people have gathered against you, therefore, fear them. But it increased them in faith, and they said: "Allah is sufficient for us, and He is the best disposer of affairs." } ^ [3:173]. Said bin Jubayr reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "When Ibrahim was thrown into the fire, the keeper (angel) of the rain said: "When will I be commanded to send rain?" But the command of Allah was more swift. Allah said: 111 Al-Qurtubi , 11:303. At-Tabari, 18:465. 131 Fath Al-Bari, 8:77

467 Surah 21 . Al-Anbiua' (71-75) (Part-17) 40 fire! Be you cool and safety for Ibrahim!}, and there was no fire left on earth that was not extinguished." Ibn 'Abbas and Abu Al-'Aliyah said: "Were it not for the fact that Allah said, 4and safety}, Ibrahim would have been harmed by its coldness."*2 ' Qatadah said: "On that day there was no creature that did not try to extinguish the fire for Ibrahim, except for the gecko."*3 ' Az-Zuhri said: "The Prophet jg commanded that it should be killed, and called it a harmful vermin."*4 ' 4And they roanted to harm him, but We made them the loorst losers.} they were defeated and humiliated, because they wanted to plot against the Prophet of Allah, but Allah planned against them and saved him from the fire, and thus they were defeated. ; V\^nJLUJ jsfji JJ tiylj iSij tLjlj y* , l_J jly4j '2': - .< — V<? •>?. \ 'C' - s.'- 'a s' >'•«' 471 . And We resated him and Lilt to the land which We have blessedfor the nations.} 472. And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and Ya'qub Ndfilatan. Each one We made righteous.} 473. And We made than leaders, guiding by Our command, and We revealed to than the doing of good deeds, performing Salah, and the giving of Zakah, and of Us (Alone) they were * J At-Tabari, 18:466. * At-Tabari, 18:466,465. * At-Tabari, 18:467. * At-Tabari, 18 :467. Similar was recorded by Muslim, no. 2238.

the worshippers.} 4.74. And (remember) Lut, We gave him wisdom and knowledge, and We saved himfrom the town who practised Al- Khaba'ithP1 Verily, they were a people given to evil, and were rebellious.} 475. And We admitted him to Our mercy; truly, he was of the righteous.} The Migration ofIbrahim to Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), accompaniedby Lut Allah tells us that He saved Ibrahim from the fire lit by his people, and brought him out from among them, migrating to the land ofAsh-Sham, to the sacred regions thereof. 4And We bestowed upon him IsItaq, and Ya'qub Nafilatan .} 'Ata' and Mujahid said, "Nafilatan means as a gift."*2 ' Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah131 and Al-Hakam bin TJaynah14 ' said, "The gift of a son who has a son," meaning that Ya'qQb was the son of Ishaq, as Allah says: 4But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub [11:71]. 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "He asked for one [son], and said, 0; 4 v 4 "My Lord! Grant me from the righteous."} So Allah gave him Ishaq, and gave him Ya'qub in addition. 4<J*& %} 4Each one We made righteous.} means, both of them were good and righteous people. Meaning filthy, evil behavior. 121 At-Tabari, 18:471. Ibid. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5 :643

4And We made them leaders,} means, examples to be followed. <Z>JMi} iguiding by Our command,} inviting to Him by His leave. Allah says: 4'tjk=>)\ 'Qfi ifyj &&& We revealed to them the doing ofgood deeds, performing Salah, and the giving ofZakdh,} Here the general is followed by the specific. iand of Us (Alone) they were the worshippers.} means, they did what they enjoined others to do. The Prophet Lut Then Allah mentions Lilt, whose full name was Lilt bin Haran bin Azar. He believed in Ibrahim and followed him, and migrated with him, as Allah says: Jj o\ JSj lj) %&Q} 4So Liit believed in him. He (Ibrahim) said: "I will emigrate for the sake ofmy Lord"} [29:26]. Allah gave him wisdom and knowledge; He sent Revelation to him, made him a Prophet and appointed him to Sadum (Sodom) and its vicinity, but they rejected him and resisted him, so Allah utterly destroyed them, as He tells us in several places in His Book. Allah says; xsss.' . ' >{ i 7- . > 4and We saved him from the town who practised Al-Khabd'ith. Verily, they were a people given to evil, and were rebellious. And Weadmittedhim toOurmercy ; truly, hewasofthe righteous « 'Jxz ij C%} A*'-*' '* t *>£, >***'

476. And (remember) Niih, when he cried (to Us) aforetime. We answered to his invocation and saved him and his family from the great distress.} 477. We helped him against the people who denied Our Ayat. Verily, they were a people given to evil. So We drowned them all. Nuh and His People Allah tells us how He responded to His servant and Messenger Nuh, peace be upon him, when he prayed to Him against his people for their disbelief in him: , f > *L> 4Then he invoked his Lord (saying): "I have been overcome, so help (me)!" [54:10] 'Jj 'ji-r" (Uj* o[S&l ujiiV' je j'S> 'j Cf) fy itij} l>£ ijut 4And Niih said: "My Lord! Leave not any inhabitant of the disbelievers on the earth! If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants, and they will beget none but wicked disbelievers} [71:26-27]. So Allah says here, ifc'j j* t£l& i[] 4And (remember) Niih, when he cried (to Us) aforetime. We answered to his invocation and saved him and his family} meaning, those who believed with him, as Allah says elsewhere: ,iZ £1: tj &\$,} 4 . . .and your family - except him against whom the Word has already gone forth - and those who believe. And none believed with him, except a few} [1 1:40]. 11^ 7} 4from the great distress.} meaning, from difficulty, rejection and harm. For he remained among them for one thousand years less

473 Surah 23. Al-Anbiud' (78-82) (Part-17) H2KJ8SS rrA ^ flfty. calling them to --' 'Y •'i'^ ^ <{Vp Ovi —1 Allah, and no one had believed in him except for a few. His people were plotting against him and advising one another century after century, generation after generation, to oppose him. <£XZii£%> 4We helped him against the people^ means, "We saved him and helped him against the people," m & <s#» *v: r>.^ />- (*> iUE iwho denied Our Ayat. Verily, they were a people given to evil. So We drowned them all.} meaning, Allah drowned them all, and not one of them was left on the face of the earth, as their Prophet had prayed would happen to them. /j& (U* oJ-ii ^fp. ^ ^ JC5J' tLS ui; ^=>j Jci: ^ ^ L£=,J Ijj Qfp Jjfi jffi Uy^ iirfle juilj .<V, / / > // y . »// >' . ^ wj >—*— *>j -d 04 v •jA) J~ 478. And (remember) Dawud and Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain [*V 1i*r\-*}_y- ' ^ l^> ->]. <4o'— ijJu^j j^^cWr' 'Z" >/^ •>"* •x' ^ ^ 1 /'V > ^ < »//

people had Nafashat; and We were witness to their judgement.} 479. And We made Sulayman to understand (the case); and to each of them We gave wisdom (Hukm) and knowledge. And We subjected the mountains and the birds to glorify Our praises along with Dawud. And it was We Who were the doer (of all these things). 480. And We taught him the making of metal coats of mail (for battles), to protect you in your fighting. Are you then grateful?} 481. And to Sulayman (We subjected) the wind strongly raging, running by his command towards the land which We had blessed. And of everything We are the All-Knower.} 482. And of the Shayatin were some who dived for him, and did other work besides that; and it was We Who guarded them.} Dawud and Sulayman and the Signs which They were given; the Story of the People whose Sheep pastured at Night in the Field [Abu] Ishaq narrated from Murrah from Ibn MasTid: "That crop was grapes, bunches of which were dangling."111 This was also the view of Shurayh.121 Ibn 'Abbas said: "Nafash means grazing."131 Shurayh, Az-Zuhri and Qatadah said: "Nafash only happens at night."14 ' Qatadah added, "[and] Al-Haml is grazing during the day."151 > 't 4And (remember) Daioud and Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain people had pastured at night;} Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Mas*ud said: "Grapes which had grown and their bunches were spoiled by the sheep. .Dawud At-Tabari, 18:474. At-Tabari 18:475. At-Tabari 18:477, 478. ,4) At-Jabari 18:477, 478. |S| At-Tabari 18:477.

473 Surah 21. Al-Anbiva' (78-82) (Part-17) (David) ruled that the owner of the grapes should keep the sheep. Sulayman (Solomon) said, 'Not like this, O Prophet of Allah!' [Dawud] said, 'How then?' [Sulayman] said: 'Give the grapes to the owner of the sheep and let him tend them until they grow back as they were, and give the sheep to the owner of the grapes and let him benefit from them until the grapes have grown back as they were. Then the grapes should be given back to their owner, and the sheep should be given back to their owner.' This is what Allah said: 4 And We made Sulayman to understand (the case) .^ also reported by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas. [2] itl; Q\ This was 4 And We made Sulayman to understand (the case); and to each of them I've gave wisdom and knowledge Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that when Iyas bin Mu'awiyah was appointed as a judge, Al-Hasan came to him and found Iyas weeping. [Al-Hasan] said, "Why are you weeping?" [Iyas] said, "O Abu Said, What I heard about judges among them a judge is he, who studies a case and his judgment is wrong, so he will go to Hell; another judge is he who is biased because of his own whims and desires, so he will go to Hell; and the other judge he who studies a case and gives the right judgement, so he will go to Paradise." Al-Hasan Al-Basari said: "But what Allah tells us about Dawud and Sulayman (peace be upon them both) and the Prophets and whatever judgements they made proves that what these people said is wrong. Allah says: \&& 4 And (remember) Dawud and Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain people had pastured at night; and We were witness to their judgement. 111 At-Jabari 18:475. 121 At-Tabari 18:475.

474 TafsTr Ibn Kathlr Allah praised Sulayman but He did not condemn Dawud." Then he - Al-Hasan - said, "Allah enjoins three things upon the judges: not to sell thereby for some miserable price; not to follow their own whims and desires; and not to fear anyone concerning their judgements." Then he recited: 4,0 Dawud! Verily, We have placed you as a successor on the earth; so judge you between men in truth and follow not your desire -for it will mislead you from the path of Allah. [38:26] i Therej brefear not men but fear Me} [5:44] 62 #tL i 4 and sell not My Aydt for a miserable price.} [5:44] (1 ' I say: with regard to the Prophets (peace be upon them all), all of them were infallible and supported by Allah. With regard to others, it is recorded in Sahth. Al-Bukhari from 'Amir bin Al-'As that the Messenger of Allah jg said: -I Xf>- \ lilj i aJU iOUjU 'ff 1 lilt *If the judge does his best, studies the case and reaches the right conclusion, he will have two rewards. If he does his best, studies the case and reaches the wrong conclusion, he will have one reward. This Hadith refutes the idea of Iyas, who thought that if he did his best, studied the case and reached the wrong conclusion, he would go to Hell. And Allah knows best. Similar to story in the Qur'an is the report recorded by Imam Ahmad in his Musnad from Abu Hurayrah, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: ifl tb*. si t jiLi ^ 1 \jjLS :3lii jU-LS ~ *O I as* * Sj IS [I Tahdhtb Tarikh Dimashq 3 :184 ; Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2458 FathAl-Bari 13:330.

SjiJaLl <i n? L^jl 'yt. ajbl oJU i :Uiw *There were two women who each had a son. The wolf came and took one of the children, and they referred their dispute to Daiuud. He ruled that the (remaining) child belonged to the older woman. They left, then Sulayman called them and said, "Give me a sword and I will divide him between the two of you." The younger woman said, "May Allah have mercy on you! He is her child, do not cut him up!" So he ruled that the child belonged to the younger woman. ' 1 This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim in their Sahihs. W An-Nasal also devoted a chapter to this in the Book of Judgements.*3 ' 4 And We subjected the mountains and the birds to glorify Our praises along with Daiuud.} This refers to the beauty of his voice when he recited his Book, Az-Zabur. When

he recited it in a beautiful manner, the birds would stop and hover in the air, and would repeat after him, and the mountains would respond and echo his words. The Prophet passed by Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari while he was reciting Qur'an at night, and he had a very beautiful voice, he stopped and listened to his recitation, and said: "ijli JI -til "This man has been given one of the wind instruments (nice voices) of the family of Dawud." He said: "O Messenger of Allah, if I had known that you were listening, I would have done my best for you." 41 4And We taught him the making of metal coats of mail, to protect you in your fighting.} m Ahmad 2:322. Al-Bukhari 6769; Muslim 1720. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5958 FathAl-Bari 8:711.

476 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, the manufacture of chain-armor. Qatadah said that before that, they used to wear plated armor; he was the first one to make rings of chain-armor.' ' This is like the Ayah: j 0^1 JS 4\$ iJi 'J \$And We made the iron soft for him. Saying: "Make you perfect coats of mail, and balance well the rings of chain armor") [34:10-11], meaning, do not make the pegs so loose that the rings (of chain mail) will shake, or make it so tight that they will not be able to move at all. Allah says: ipLX & fcEs) 4to protect you in your fighting.) meaning, in your battles. p&) 4Are you then grateful?) means, 'Allah blessed you when He inspired His servant Dawud and taught him that for your sake.' The Power of Sulayman is unparalleled 4And to Sulayman (We subjected) the wind strongly raging,) means, We subjugated the strong wind to Sulayman. 4running by his command towards the land which We had blessed.) meaning, the land of Ash-Sham (Greater Syria). 4And of everything We are the All-Knower.) He had a mat made of wood on which he would place all the equipment of his kingship; horses, camels, tents and troops, then he would command the wind to carry it, and he would go underneath it and it would carry him aloft, shading him and protecting him from the heat, until it reached wherever he IM At-Tabari 18:480.

477 Surah 21 . Al-Anbiva' (83-84) (Part-17) wanted to go in the land. Then it would come down and deposit his equipment and entourage. Allah says: it. 4So, We subjected to him the wind; it blew gently by his order whithersoever he willed.} [38:36] iits morning was a month's (journey), and its afternoon was a month's} [34:12] 4 v 0} L*.J' cZfso} \$And of the ShaydtTn were some who dived for him,} means, they dived into the water to retrieve pearls, jewels, etc., for him. iand did other work besides that;} This is like the Ayah 4 ov*- iAnd also the ShaydtTn, every kind of builder and diver. And also others bound in fetters.} [38:37-38]. iand it was We Who guarded them.} means, Allah protected him lest any of these ShaydtTn did him any harm. All of them were subject to his control and domination, and none of them would have dared to approach him. He was in charge of them and if he wanted, he could set free or detain whomever among them he wished. Allah says: iAnd also others bound in fetters.} [38:38] '<& ^ \$& ttse i] c%} " i" * ' •>"* ><• " *t ^ f 483. And (remember) Ayyiib, when he cried to his Lord: "Verily, distress has seized me, and You are the Most Merciful

of all those who show mercy. 484. So We answered his call, and We removed the distress that was on him, and We restored his family to him, and the like thereof along with them as a mercy from Ourselves and a Reminder for all those who worship Us. y The Prophet Ayyub Allah tells us about Ayyub (Job), and the trials that struck him, affecting his wealth, children and physical health. He had plenty of livestock, cattle and crops, many children and beautiful houses, and he was tested in these things, losing every thing he had. Then he was tested with regard to his body, and he was left alone on the edge of the city

and there was no one who treated him with compassion apart from his wife, who took care of him. It was said that it reached the stage where she was in need, so she started to serve people (to earn money) for his sake. The Prophet ﷺ said: $\text{جاءني رجل فقال لي يا رسول الله ما أشد ما ابتلي من هؤلاء}$ "The people who are tested the most severely are the Prophets, then the righteous, then the next best and the next best*" According to another Hadith: "A man will be tested according to his level of religious commitment; the stronger his religious commitment, the more severe will be his test.*" The Prophet of Allah, Ayyub, upon him be peace, had the utmost patience, and he is the best example of that. Yazid bin Maysarah said: "When Allah tested Ayyub, upon him be peace, with the loss of his family, wealth and children, and he had nothing left, he started to focus upon the remembrance of Allah, and he said: 'I praise You, the Lord of lords. Who bestowed His kindness upon me and gave me wealth and children, and there was no corner of my heart that was not filled with attachment to these worldly things, then You took them away from me.' " At-Tabarani 24:245, 246. ' Ahmad 1 :180.

479 Surah 21. Al-Anbiyyat (83-84) (Part-17 all of that away from me and You emptied my heart, and there is nothing to stand between me and You. If my enemy Iblis knew of this, he would be jealous of me.' When Iblis heard of this, he became upset. And Ayyub, upon him be peace, said: 'O Lord, You gave me wealth and children, and there was no one standing at my door complaining of some wrong I had done to him. You know that. I used to have a bed prepared for me, but I forsook it and said to myself: You were not created to lie on a comfortable bed. I only forsook that for Your sake.' " This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet ﷺ said: $\text{قال رسول الله ﷺ ما أشد ما ابتلي من هؤلاء}$ "The people who are tested the most severely are the Prophets, then the righteous, then the next best and the next best*" When Allah healed Ayyub, He sent upon him a shower of golden locusts, and he started to pick them up and gather them in his garment. It was said to him, "O Ayyub, have you not had enough?" He said, "O Lord, who can ever have enough of Your mercy?" [2] The basis of this Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahih, as we shall see below. jui 4 and We restored his family to him (that he had lost) and the like thereof along with them. It was reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "They themselves were restored to him." This was also narrated by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas. Something similar was also narrated from Ibn Mas'ud and Mujahid, and this was the view of Al-Hasan and Qatadah. 151 Mujahid said: "It was said to him, 'O Ayyub, your family will be with you in Paradise; if you want, We will bring Hilyat Al-Awliya' 5 :239 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2461, similar with Al-Bukhari no. 3391 131 At-Tabari 18:506, 507. At-Tabari 18:506, 507. At-Tabari 18:506, 507.

them back to you, or if you want, We will leave them for you in Paradise and will compensate you with others like them.' He said, 'No, leave them for me in Paradise.' So they were left for him in Paradise, and he was compensated with others like them in this world." } 4 as a mercy from Ourselves} means, *We did that to him as a mercy from Allah towards him.' and a Reminder for all those who worship Us.} means, "We made him an example lest those who are beset by trials think that We do that to them because We do not care for them, so that they may take him as an example of patience in accepting the decrees of Allah and bearing the trials with which He tests His servants as He wills.' And Allah has the utmost wisdom with regard to that. X' *V- • * > 4 » ^3w ij* cfl r? \ y i yfS' • L« j • L^ . SsS t a! 1^ - O^ Lt^ li AycAA fijj "ht " y* \yitt /- > . - 7- . > ' . 'A' *4%. |*p s'y y *i i *? 5 ^ y'J. yy s' "J A * s'y 4S5. And (remember) Isma'il, Idris and Dhul-Kifl: All were from among the patient.} 486. And We admitted them to Our mercy. Verily, they were of the righteous.}

481 Surah 21. Al-Anbi'ud' (87-88) (Part-17) Isma'11, Idris and Dhul-Kifl Ismatl was the son of Ibrahim Al-Khalll, peace be upon them both. He has already been mentioned in Surah Maryam, where mention was also made of Idris. From the context and the fact that Dhul-Kifl is mentioned alongside Prophets, it appears that he was also a Prophet. Others say that he was a righteous man, a just king and a fair judge. Ibn Jarir refrained from making any decisive comment. 1 11 And Allah knows best. vi iji v j oiui)i i 4 tS ^ ojji 487. A>td (remember) Dhun-Niin, when he went off in anger, and imagined that We shall not punish him! But he cried through the darknesses (Zulumdt) (saying): "There is no Cod but You, Glorified be You! Tndy, I have been of the Zalimin ivrongdoers 488. So We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress. And thus We do deliver the believers. Yunus This story is mentioned here, and in Surat As-Saffat and Surah Nun. Yunus bin Matta, upon him be peace, was sent by Allah to the people of Nineveh, which was a town in the area of Mawsil [in northern Iraq]. He called them to Allah, but they rejected him and persisted in their disbelief. So he left them in anger, threatening them with punishment after three [days]. When they realized that he was telling the truth and that a Prophet never lies, they went out to the desert with their children and cattle and flocks. They separated the mothers from their children, then they beseeched Allah and pleaded to Him, with the camels and their young groaning, the cows and their calves mooing, and the sheep and their lambs bleating, so Allah spared them from the punishment. Allah says: HI At-Tabari 18:507.

482 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ^ yV 'toiLj Gjlf ej 4W«s f/iere any town that believed (after seeing the punishment), and its faith saved it? Except the people of Yunus; when they believed, We removed from them the torment of disgrace in the life of the ivorld, and permitted them to enjoy for a while [10:98]. Yunus, meanwhile, went and traveled with some people on a ship, which was tossed about on the sea. The people were afraid that they would drown, so they cast lots to choose a man whom they would throw overboard. The lot fell to YQnus, but they refused to throw him overboard. This happened a second and a third time. Allah says: jt£&^d} 4Then he (agreed to) cast lots, and he was among the losers.} [37:141] meaning, the draw went against him, so Yunus stood up, removed his garment and cast himself into the sea. Then Allah sent from the Green Sea - according to what Ibn MasTld said - a large fish which cleaved the oceans until it came and swallowed Yunus when he threw himself into the sea. Allah inspired that large fish not to devour his flesh or break his bones, (as if He said) Yunus is not food for you, rather your belly is a prison for him. iAnd (remember) Dhun-Niin,} Here Nun refers to the fish; it is correct for it to be attributed to him here. i_»&i iwhen he went off in anger,} Ad-Dahhak said: "Anger towards his people."11 4and imagined that We shall not punish him!} meaning, constrict him in the belly of the fish. Something m At-Tabari 18:511.

483 Surah 21 . Al-Anbiua (87-88) (Part-17) similar to this was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others . This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and he quoted as evidence for that the Ayah JjLi L» ^1 La i<A iand the man zohose resources are restricted, let him spend according to what Allah has given him. Allah puts no burden on any person beyond what He has given him. Allah will grant after hardship , ease4 (65 :7). 1\ Y» iiJi Y j ciUisf j UxTty 4But he cried through the depths of darkness (saying): "There is no God but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers Ibn Mas"fid said regarding the 'depths of darkness': "The darkness of the belly of the fish, the darkness of the sea and the darkness of the night."121 This was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, 'Amr bin MaymQn, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka"b, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan and Qatadah . 131 Salim bin Abu Al-

Ja'd said: "The darkness of the fish in the belly of another fish in the darkness of the sea."141 Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas and others said: "This was because the fish took him through the sea, cleaving it until it reached the bottom of the sea. Yunus heard the rocks at the bottom of the sea uttering glorification of Allah, at which point he said: Y-4 Y> 4There is no God but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers 'Awf Al-A'rabi said: "When YUnus found himself in the belly of the fish, he thought that he had died. Then he moved his legs. When he moved his legs, he prostrated where he was, then he 111 At-Tabari 18:514, 515. 121 Al-Qurtubi 1 1 :333 131 At-Tabari 18:516, 517. At-Tabari 18:517. 151 Ibn Abi Shaybah 1 1 :541 ; 13 :578.

484 Tafsir Ibn Kathir called out: 'O Lord, I have taken a place of worship to You in a place which no other person has reached.' if iSo We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress.} means, We brought him forth from the belly of the fish and from that darkness.' 4And thus We do deliver the believers .} means, when they are in difficulty and they call upon Us and repent to Us, especially if they call upon Us with these words at the time of distress. The leader of the Prophets sg encouraged us to call upon Allah with these words. Imam Ahmad recorded that Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "I passed by 'Uthman bin 'Affan, may Allah be pleased with him, in the Masjid, and greeted him. He stared at me but did not return my Salam. I went to 'Umar bin Al-Khattab and said: 'O Commander of the faithful, has something happened in Islam?' I said that twice. He said, 'No, why do you ask?' I said, 'I passed by 'Uthman a short while ago in the Masjid and greeted him, and he stared at me but he did not return my Salam.' Tjmar sent for *Uthman and asked him, Why did you not return your brother's Salam?' He said, That is not true.' Sa'd said, 'Yes it is.' It reached the point where they both swore oaths. Then Tjthman remembered and said, Yes, you are right, I seek the forgiveness of Allah and I repent to Him. You passed by me a short while ago but I was preoccupied with thoughts of something I had heard from the Messenger of Allah 3g, which I never think of but a veil comes down over my eyes and my heart.' Sa'd said: 'And I will tell you what it was. The Messenger of Allah 3g told us the first part of the supplication then a bedouin came and kept him busy, then the Messenger of Allah jg got up and I followed him. When I felt worried that he would enter his house, I stamped my feet. m At-Tabari 18:518.

485 Surah 21. Al-Anbiyd' (87-88) (Part-17) I turned to the Messenger of Allah jg, who said, • i iJia •Who is this? Abu Ishaq? 1 I said, "Yes, O Messenger of Allah." He said, iWhat is the matter?» I said, "Nothing, by Allah, except that you told us the first part of the supplication, then this bedouin came and kept you busy." He said, •Yes, the supplicaion of Dhun-Nun when he was in the belly of the fish 3 % ill iThere is no God but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers •«J > J I Yl Jal J(^ jJ No Muslim ever prays to his Lord with these words for anything, but He will answer his prayer. n"* 11 It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, and by An-Nasal in Al- Yawm wcd-LaylahP Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah said: •Jj Cocil [r,y. ^ Ifi ^Whoever offers supplication in tle words of the supplication of YUnus, will be answered .» Abu Said said: "He was referring to: 4And thus We do deliver the believers.y^ I 1 ' Ahmad 1 :170. *21 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 : 479 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:168. 131 Al-Hakim 2:584.

486 Tafsir Ibn Kathir A ^ -£*" dj i^Ai V Cjj %j Oiib l[~^C J^=ff}} 4 iji^=» |i^i ?J &S\j 4J iLJij U \$£- S L^;j aj 489. And (remember) Zakariyyd, when he cried to his Lord: "O My Lord! Leave me not single

(childless), though You are the Best of the inheritors."} 490. So We answered his call, and We bestowed upon him Yahya, and cured his wife for him. Verily, they used to hasten on to do good deeds, and they used to call on Us with hope and fear, and t^{lwy} were Khashi'm before Us.} Zakariyya and Yahya Allah tells us of His servant Zakariyya, who asked Allah to grant him a son who would be a Prophet after him. The story has already been given in detail at the beginning of Surah Maryam and also in Surah 'Imran. Here an abbreviated version is given. 4'Aj 4when he cried to his Lord means, in secret, hiding it from his people. V CJJ} 40 My Lord! Leave me not single,} means, with no child and no heir to stand among the people after me. jy df} 4though You are the Best of the inheritors.} This is a supplication and form of praise befitting the topic. Allah says: 4**^*-jj 'A ? }) LZLJi} 4So We answered his call, and We bestowed upon him Yahya, and cured his wife for him.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said: "She was barren and never had a child, then she gave birth. ",11 m At-Tabari 18:520.

4 \y^=> iVerily, they used to hasten on to do good deeds, means, acts of worship and acts of obedience towards Allah. iand they used to call on Us with hope andfear,} Ath-Thawri said, "Hoping for that (reward) which is with Us and fearing that (punishment) which is with Us." iand they were Khashi'in before Us.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that this means, sincerely believing in that

which was revealed by Allah. 121 Mujahid said: "Truly

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3652–3653]

believing."131 Abu Al-'Aliyah said: "Fearing. 141 Abu Sinan said: "Khushu'means the fear which should never leave our hearts." It was also reported from Mujahid that the KhashVin are those who are humble." Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said, "The KhashVin are those who humble themselves before Allah."151 All of these suggestions are close in meaning. Ajlt i 4 ' \CsScd ^j\j^ ^ 4Vt C^JliaSI 491. And she who guarded her chastity, We breathed into her through Our Ruh, and We made her and her son a sign for nations .} 'Isa and Maryam the True Believer Here Allah mentions the story of Maryam and her son Isa, just after mentioning Zakariyya and his son Yahya, may peace be upon them all. He mentions the story of Zakariyya first, followed by the story of Maryam because the one is connected to the other. The former is the story of a child being bom to TafsirAth-Thawri204 At-Tabari 16:2. 131 At-Tabari 16:2. At-Tabari 16:2. 151 Al-Kashshaf3 :133 , Al-Baghawi 3 :267 , Ibn Abi Shaybah 13 :580

488 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr an old man of advanced years, from an old woman who had been barren and had never given birth when she was younger. Then Allah mentions the story of Maryam which is even more wondrous, for in this case a child was born from a female without (the involvement of) a male. These stories also appear in Surah Al Imran and in Surah Maryam. Here Allah mentions

the story of Zakariyya and follows it with the story of Maryam,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3653–3654]

where He says: 4And she who guarded her chastity,} means, Maryam (peace be upon her). This is like the Ayah in Surah At-Tahrim: at & 4And Maryam, the daughter of 'Imran who guarded her chastity. And We breathed into it [her garment] through Our Ruh [66:12). ihi4& &£} 4and We made her and her

son a sign for the nations .} means, evidence that Allah is able to do all things and that He creates whatever He wills; verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, “Be” - and it is! This is like the Ayah: 4And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind [19:21] •S-sf—i 'Jirt==” ' .''I'l l ' .1—” i U! . 492. Truly, this, your Ummah is one, and I am your Lord, therefore worship Me.} 493. But they have broken up and differed in their religion among themselves. (And) they all shall return to Us.} 494. So whoever does righteous good deeds while he is a believer, his efforts will not be rejected. Verily, We record itfor him (in his Book ofdeeds).}

Mankind is One Ummah &p iTruhj, this, your Ummah is one,} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “Your religion is one religion.” 1 11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: “In this Ayah, Allah explains to them what they should avoid and what they should do.” Then He said: &p\ iTruly, this, your Ummah is one religion,} “Meaning, your path is one path. Certainly this is your Sharfah (Divine Law) which I have clearly explained you.” So Allah says: p=uj \$>} iand I am your Lord, therefore worship Me.} This is like the Ayah i&C clp U& j &} 40 (you) Messettgers! Eat of the Tayyibdt (good things) and do righteous deeds.} Until His saying, 4And I am your Lord, so have Taqioa ofMe.} [23 :51 -52 The Messenger of Allah said: Wji jlLiS/l 34^ j*’-8 ^We Prophets are brothers from different mothers and our religion is one . »’21

What is meant here is that they all worshipped Allah Alone

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3654–3663]

with no partner or associate, although the Laws of each Messenger may have differed, as Allah says: **iri &¥ 4To each among you, We have prescribed a Law and a clear way} [5 :48] At-Tabari 18:523. , 2) Fath Al-Bari 6 :550

•> ! \jL£juj) ^Bttt they have broken up and differed in their religion among themselves.) meaning, the nations were divided over their Messengers; some of them believed in them and some rejected them. Allah says: i(And) they all shall return to Us.) meaning, ‘on the Day of Resurrection, when We will requite each person according to his deeds. If they are good, then he will be rewarded and if they are evil then he will be punished.’ Allah says: jlju <So whoever does righteous good deeds while he is a believer,) meaning, his heart believes and his deeds are righteous. yS) ihis efforts will not be rejected.) This is like the Ayah o—^ if4 j^ ^4" V icertainly We shall not make the reward of anyone who does his deeds in the most perfect manner to be lost.) [18:30] which means, his efforts will not be wasted; they will be appreciated and not even a speck of dust’s weight of injustice will be done. Allah says: i Verily, We record itfor him.) means, all his deeds are recorded and nothing of them at all is lost. > j , < {Sr’i IjI is . 4 L£=> aHit irk— \”<rr \ 'At <95. And a ban is laid on every town which We have destroyed that they shall not return.) <96. Until, when Yajuj and Ma’jiij (Cog and Magog people)

491Surah 21. Al-Anbiyd' (95-97) (Part-17) are let loose, and they swoop downfrom every Hadab 497. And the true promise shall draw near. Then you shall see the eyes of the disbelievers fixedly staring in horror. (They will say:) "Woe to us! We were indeed heedless of this - nay, but we were xorongdoers Those who have been destroyed, will never return to this World 4And a ban is laid on every town> Ibn ‘Abbas said, “it is enforced”, i.e., it has been decreed that the people of each township that has been

destroyed will never return to this world before the Day of Resurrection, as is reported clearly [through other narrations] from Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Ja’far Al-Baqir, Qatadah and others. Ya’juj and Ma’juj iUntil, when Ya’juj and Ma’juj are let loose> We have already mentioned that they are from the progeny of Adam, upon him be peace; they are also descents of Nuh through his son Yafith (Japheth), who was the father of the Turks, Turk referring to the group of them who were left behind the barrier which was built by Dhul-Qarnayn. Allah says: *jj Jiy ofj /W jj Jej bji 4, O' 4^:4 477ns is a mercy from my Lord, but xohen the promise ofmy Lord comes, He shall level it down to the ground. And the promise of my Lord is ever true. And on that Day, We shall leave them to surge like waves on one another..^[18:98-99]. And in this Ayah, Allah says: 111 Al-Baghawi 3 :268 , At-Tabari 18 :525 , Ar-RSzi 22 : 19 1*

{Until, when Ya’juj and Ma’juj are let loose, and they swoop down from every Hadab.\$ meaning, they will come forth quickly to spread corruption. A Hadab is a raised portion of land. This was the view of Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ikrimah, Abu Salih, Ath-Thawri and others. ' This is how their emergence is described, as if the listener can see it. {And none can inform you like Him Wlw is the AU-Knower.) [35:14). This is information given by the One Who knows what has happened and what is yet to come, the One Who knows the unseen in the heavens and on earth. There is no god except Him. Ibn Jarir narrated that ‘Ubaydullah bin Abi Yazid said, “Ibn ‘Abbas saw some young boys playing and pouncing on one another, and said, this is how Ya’juj and Ma’jaj will emerge.”² Their emergence has been described in numerous Hadiths of the Prophet jgg. The First Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said: “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: *foi\ 'j* j\^ » Llolj U j ij? Y| Cr? fr fy t j*~ 4 “*j* (if* j\lS ji : : Jli Jil Jif Wy* JU toxl j\ J^cij l*S 4-dW jjj j\LUl J\ LfJ fji'ji jj (*-*.*>-f jii j*J J*-j 'fr iil y\Ju l_JU Ullli liiiJlj : JjZt 1 1;-*- Y Jiy ^ gyn ^JJ> [11 At-Tabari 18:532. At-Tabari 18:528.*

493Surah 21 . Al-Anbiua' (95-97) (Part-17 ^ jJrj :JU lii u Li; 0 J4-3 ^ ' , , > ,y - . , , # > ' * , l/ y . >• , ^ ' , *C •* ' • t J AjI <yP • tj^jJLp -Vi 3^" ^ ^ ^ ^! ^3 (4J ^ i f4r--'3i In «U oLii oil)) Jj*-' Ir*' ‘-j^' t j— f-f-* A —’ «Ya’jiij and Ma’juj will be let loose and will emerge upon mankind, as Allah says: iand they swoop doion from every Hadab> They will overwhelm the people, and the Muslims will retreat to their cities and strongholds, bringing their flocks ivith than. They [Ya’juj and Ma’juj] will drink all the water of the land until some of them will pass a river and drink it dry, then those who come after them will pass by that place and will say, "There used to be water here once." Thai there will be no one left except those who are in their strongholds and cities. Then one of than will say, "We have defeated the people of the earth; now the people of heaven are left." One of them will shake his spear and hurl it into the sky, and it will come back stained with blood, as a test and a trial for them. While this is happahng, Allah will said a worm in their necks, like the worm that is found in date-stones or in the nostrils of sheep, and they will die and their clamor will cease. Then the Muslims will say, "Who will volunteer to find out what the enemy is doing?" One of them will step forward and volunteer, knowing that he will likely be killed. He will go down and will find them dead, lying on top of one another. Then he will call out, " Muslims! Rejoice that Allah has sufficed you against your enemy!" Then they will come out of their cities and strongholds, and will let their flocks out to graze, but they zoill have nothing to graze upon except the flesh of these people (Ya’juj and Ma’juj), but it will fill them better than any vegetation they have ever eaten before .»*** It was also recorded by Ibn Majah. 111 Ahmad 3:77. •2| Ibn Majah 2:1363.

494 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Second Hadith Imam Ahmad also recorded from An-Nawwas bin Sam'an Al-Kilabi that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) mentioned the Dajjal one morning. "Sometimes he described him as insignificant and sometimes he described him as so significant that we felt as if he were in the cluster of palm trees." 111 He said: $\hat{\alpha} \text{ t} \hat{\alpha} \text{ U d U j l y. } \{ \text{ j i i j d i M 3 } '(4^{\wedge} \text{ - } * \text{ j } * \text{ J } * \text{ I }^{\wedge} \text{ } \hat{\alpha} \text{ u i } \} \text{ , d j i } \hat{\alpha} \text{ J i i j } \text{ . i b u, j J U } "$ lywl 411 Slip U I'VILiJ "There are other things that I fear for you more than the Dajjal. If he emerges while I am among you, I will deal with him for you. If he emerges when I am not among you, then each man will have to deal with him for himself, and Allah will take care of each Muslim on my behalf. He (the Dajjal) will be a young man with short, curly hair and a floating eye. He will emerge in a place between Syria and Iraq and will spread mischief right and left. O servants of Allah, be steadfast!» We said, 'O Messenger of Allah, how long will he remain on earth?' He said, $\bullet \text{ f-tf } 5 \text{ } (* \text{ j d J } (* \text{ _ }) * \text{ i U }) \text{ j } "$ "Forty days: one day like a year, one day like a month, one day like a week, and the rest of the days like your days." We said, 'O Messenger of Allah, on that day which will be like a year, will the prayers of one day and one night be sufficient?' He said, $\text{ o j j J } 4 \text{ } \text{ I j j j J I } \text{ i V } \text{ ® } "$ When that happened, he could see it in our faces. We asked him about that and said, 'O Messenger of Allah, you mentioned the Dajjal this morning and spoke as if he was insignificant, and now you have described him as so significant that we feel as though he is in the cluster of palm trees'. (This portion is not found in Ibn Kathir's original manuscript, but is available in the Hadith collection of Ahmad)

495 Surah 21. Al-Anbiya' (95-97) (Part-17) uNo, but you will have to compute it according to its due proportion (and pray accordingly).» We said, 'O Messenger of Allah, how fast will he move across the land?' He said, «Like a cloud driven by the wind.» He said, $\text{ s u m p t e } * 5 \text{ } \text{ p i } > \text{ l i } * \bullet > ' \bullet > 1 \text{ } 1 \text{ } \wedge * \text{ } | * * \bullet \bullet \text{ ' T } "$ h i * " &>- $\bullet * \text{ J } \# ' \text{ i i } \text{ I } ' > \wedge \text{ } \backslash \text{ y } \backslash < * \text{ - } \text{ Z J } \text{ t A J y } \text{ a J U - } 4 \text{ u J - r } \wedge \text{ P }^{\wedge} * > * \text{ ' In Cr? v X ' - l l } " \bullet \text{ J l S - J } > \ll \text{ J l } \text{ — } \text{ l } \gg \text{ l } \text{ £ } "$ kajjJ <*-“ $\text{ p i } \text{ u i i i t } \text{ i } 44\text{-}3 \text{ } \text{ j l } \text{ £ } \text{ t d j } \text{ j J l i } \text{ p } * \text{ i; } \text{ p } \wedge \text{ y } 4 \wedge \text{ ' j i r } \text{ J j o h } \gg \text{ U i u J l } \text{ o j l L } \ll \text{ J l } \text{ - U p } \text{ J t } \wedge \wedge \text{ M } * > \text{ c } * > ' / , * \text{ s } * \text{ r } \bullet \bullet \text{ ' } \bullet \text{ I } | \text{ - } \bullet \text{ i } \ll * \text{ . i } * \gg \# \bullet * ' \bullet ' \text{ t } ' . * \bullet 4 \bullet \text{ U l i L s } \text{ O j J L i } 4 \text{ _ } \text{ p - J } \text{ f c } \wedge \text{ j X J U } \wedge \text{ y p } 4 \text{ r f - U } \text{ U - } \wedge \text{ j } \text{ k } \wedge \text{ - U o } \text{ J H - - } \text{ J l } \text{ J }^{\wedge} \text{ - } 3 \text{ p. } \text{ J i l l } \text{ i l } 4 \text{ d U i S } \text{ p i } \text{ U } \text{ £ i } \text{ - } : \text{ J } 15 \text{ - } \text{ £ } \gg \text{ p } * \text{ J I } \text{ j J } \text{ £ p } \text{ J i l } \text{ O l J b } \text{ i }^{\wedge} \text{ a U p } \text{ p; } \text{ l S C } \& \text{ J } \gg \text{ p i } \text{ f }^{\wedge} \text{ L J l } 4 \text{ p i - } \text{ p p } \text{ p i } \text{ p — } \text{ J l i } \text{ l } > \text{ S } 4 \wedge \text{ j }^{\wedge} \text{ - U j } \{ \text{ r y r h } 3 * \wedge * : * \text{ ' j p d l } \text{ p } | \text{ j p } \text{ y U } \text{ p L } \Rightarrow \text{ P } \text{ u M } \bullet \text{ ' He i a i } // \text{ co/we to a people and call them [to his way] and they will respond to him . He will issue a command to the sky and it will rain, and to the earth and it will bring forth vegetation, then their livestock will come to them in the evening with their humps very high and their udders full of milk and their flanks wide and fat. Then he will come to another people and call them [to his way] and they will refuse, and their wealth will leave with him, and they will be faced with drought, with none of their wealth left. Then he will walk through the wasteland and will say to it, "Bring forth your treasure," and its treasure will come forth like a swarm of bees . Then he will issue commands that a man be killed, and he will strike him with a sword and cut him into two pieces, and (put these pieces as far apart) as } "$

— Tafsir Ibn Kathir the distance between an archer and his target. Then he will call him, and the man will come to him with his face shining. At that point Allah will send the Messiah 'Isa bin Maryam, who will come down to the white minaret in the eastern side of Damascus, wearing two garments lightly dyed with saffron and with his hands resting on the wings of two angels. He will search for him (the Dajjal) until he catches up with him at the eastern gate of Ludd, where he will kill him. Then Allah will reveal to 'Isa bin Maryam the words: "I have brought forth from amongst My creatures people against whom none will be able to fight. Take My servants safely to the Mount (Tiftr)." Then Allah will send Ya'juj and Ma'juj, as Allah says : and they swoop down from every Hadab '•&J y- <*' J l J j j S*; y i j _ * "

L& ^ J*} j^Lij j* ?"* Ai yj & ^Vl «Jii ju^ juls Jii ""Isa and his companions will beseech Allah, and Allah will send against them insects which will attack their necks, and in the morning they will all perish as one. Then 'Isa and his companions will come doivn and they will notfind a single spot on earth that is free from their putrefaction and stench. Then fsd and his companions will again beseech Allah, and He will send birds with necks like those of Bactrian camels, and they will carry them and throw them wherever Allah wills . Ibn Jabir said: "Ata' bin Yazld As-Saksaki told me, from Ka*b or someone else: They will throw them into Al-Mahbal.' Ibn Jabir said: "I said, 'O Abu Yazid, and where is Al-Mahbal?" He said, "In the east (where the sun rises)." He said: jl} Yj fx» cJ,o Y I^L» <3il J liUjJIS j* jl^ ^ '444; jjlh: . (4*11 jr? oLIJij t jJbi\ s? y, ^lUl (_#«SvX] Uoj y,j y ill il iilJi JU jJL Ul3 :Jli todI jA?

' ' {' Jj>- U5~ yt y j* j' _ (4^* J # "Then Allah zwill send rain which no house of clay or (tent of) camel's hair xoill be able to keep out, for forty days, and the earth ivill be washed until it looks like a mirror. Then it will be said to the earth: bring forth your fruit and restore your blessing. On that day a group ofpeople ivill be able to eatfrom one pomegranate and seek shade under its skin, and everything ivill be blessed. A milch-camel will give so much milk that it will be sufficient for a whole group of people, and a milch-cow will give so much milk that it ivill be sufficient for a whole clan, and a sheep will be sufficient for an entire household. At thaf time Allah will send a pleasant wind which will reach beneath their armpits and will take the soul of every Muslim - or every believer - and there will be left only the most evil of people who will commit fornication like mules, and then the Hour will come upon theniX '1) This was also recorded by Muslim¹² ' but not by Al-Bukhari. It was also recorded by the Sunan compilers, with different chains of narrators. At-Tirmidhi said, "It is Hasan Sahib."³ The Third Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn Harmalah, from his maternal aunt who said: "The Messenger of Allah jg gave a Khutbah, and he had a bandage on his finger where he had been stung by a scorpion. He said: I IjAfc jkte jjl\y V J '.ofyC (*&!> OUwdl ^yrj Sis' "You say that you have no enemy, but you will keep fighting your enemies until Ya'juj and Ma'juj come, with their wide Ahmad 5:181 121 Muslim 4 :2250 ' Abu Dawud 4 :496 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :499 , An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :235 , Ibn Majah 2 : 1356

faces, small eyes and reddish hair, pouring down from every mound with theirfaces looking like burnished shields Ibn Abi Hatim recorded a Hadith ofMuhammad bin 'Amr from Khalid bin 'Abdullah bin Harmalah Al-Mudlaji, from his paternal aunt, from the Prophet jg, and he mentioned something similar.¹² It was confirmed by Hadiths that 'Isa bin Maryam will perform Hajj to the Al-Bayt Al-'Atiq (i.e., the Ka'bah). Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said said: "The Messenger of Allah Sg said: «He will certainly come to this House and perform Hajj and 'Umrah, after the emergence of Ya'juj and Ma'juj This was recorded by Al-Bukhari.*3 i&\ L+fiz&} iAnd the true promise (Day of Resurrection) shall draw near

the Day of Resurrection, when these terrors and earthquakes

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3663–3679]

and this chaos will come to pass. The Hour has drawn nigh and when it comes to pass, the disbelievers will say: "This is a difficult Day." Allah says: Of-d' jZZ Zt 'iji^ iThen, you shall see the eyes of the

disbelievers fixedly staring in horror.} because of the horror of the tremendous events that they are witnessing. iWoe to us!} means, they will say, *Woe to us!' ^ jbJu. j ls=s> ji} 4jWe were indeed heedless of this} means, in the world. *** Ahmad 5:271. There is a deficiency in its chain. It may be supported by other narrations 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2468. Ahmad 3:27, Al-Bukhari 1593.

499Surah 21. Al-Anbim' (98-103) (Part-17 •a! >y*zjy(>-ft ' >. « >/> > > > C|P ^>-Lj^>-L ^==4\$ 5jJi- ^-1^3jft=>Jftft U 4_ft)J ft / .If' . (BS4 / >^ •".<./ . •>» . 's' , »>< < > />*, '- ' < '\$ ' •> Jf,c. >< • . , 11^=. jl)> 4nay, but we were wrongdoers. they will admit their wrong- doing at the time when that will not help them at all. oi 1^=0^ ^ ^ >—s>' >-4^“ i -y.^jy & >/// >./ —y / Lajjjj U {\$ {\$££& ft fe> v ft.j ^3 i4; Jlft ftj> !>i ft jftji ftiii ft ftj ftft4 V :f£ -yifti c: ^ ftj tftft y tfjftift *'> \u >"-u >>>.'j\£=>yi jftii (*4^ ""• : , v >/ ^ •> •* >\s% - / x j/ //« . » v-"" 4 «^£> L^JJ' pSOjj 'ift* A^st^IJ > j S l. .lj 498. Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel (Hasab) for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} 499. Had these been gods, they would not have entered there (Hell), and all ofthem will abide therein forever.} 4100. Therein they will be breathing out with deep sighs and roaring and therein they will hear not.} 4101. Verily, those for whom the good has preceded from Us, they will be removedfar therefrom (Hell).} 4102. They shall not hear the slightest sound of it (Hell), while they abide in that which their own selves desire.}

501Surah 21. Al-Anbiyd' (98-103) (Part-17) 4vj^~ IJj iand all of them will abide therein forever. means, the worshippers and the objects of their worship will all abide therein forever. 4Therein they will be breathing out ivith deep sighs and roaring^ This is like the Ayah Q fit 4they will have (in the Fire), Zafir and Shahiq} [11:106]. Zafir refers to their exhalation, and Shahiq refers to their inhalation. 4and therein they will hear not.} The State ofthe Blessed 4&2X \% (4J 4Verily, thosefor whom the good has precededfrom Us,} Ikrimah said, “Mercy.” Others said it means being blessed. 4\$A2£ tyfo 4they will be removedfar therefrom .^' 1| When Allah mentions the people of Hell and their punishment for their associating others in worship with Allah, He follows that with a description of the blessed who believed in Allah and His Messengers. These are the ones for whom the blessing has preceded from Allah, and they did righteous deeds in the world, as Allah says: !£d <\$> 4For those who have done good is the best reward and even more} [10:26] IM Af-Tabari 18:451.

ils there any rewardfor good other than good?} [55:60] Just as they did good in this world, Allah will make their final destiny and their reward good; He will save them from punishment and give them a great reward. v £ iiji ithey will be removed far therefrom. They shall not hear the slightest sound of it,} means, they will not feel its heat in their bodies. c j ^Xs} iwhile they abide in that which their own selves desire.} means, they will be safe from that which they fear, and they will have all that they love and desire. It was said that this was revealed to point out an exception in the case of those who are worshipped instead of Allah, and to exclude TJzayr and the Messiah from their number. Hajjaj bin Muhammad Al- A*war reported from Ibn Jurayj, and 'Uthman bin 'Ata' reported from Ibn 'Abbas: fj* iJJJU—jo Li iCertainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} Then He made an exception and said: (*4J o-llC. iVerily, thosefor whom the good has precededfrom Us.} It was said that this referred to the angels and 'IsA, and others who are worshipped instead of Allah. This was the view of 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan and Ibn Jurayj. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said in his book of Sirah: “According to what I have heard, the

Messenger of Allah ﷺ sat down one day with Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlah in the Masjid, and An-Nadr bin Al-Harith came and sat down with them. There were also other men of Quraysh in the Masjid. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ spoke, then An-Nadr bin Al-Harith

came up to him and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ spoke to him until he defeated him in argument. Then he recited to him and to them, <﴿قُلْ إِنَّكُمْ تَعْبُدُونَ أَوْثَانًا مُّذَمَّنًا ۖ إِنَّمَا يُهَمِّلُهُ الَّذِينَ لَا كَرَامَةَ فِيهِمْ ۚ إِنَّهُمْ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ شَيْئًا مِّنَ الدِّينِ ۚ هُمْ لَا يَرْجِعُونَ﴾﴾. A, -5, v 4 Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it. \$ Until His Statement, and therein they will hear not > Then the Messenger of Allah ﷺ got up and went to sit with ‘Abdullah bin Al-Zab‘ari As-Sahmi. Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlah said to ‘Abdullah bin Al-Zab‘ari, “By Allah, An-Nadr bin Al-Harith could not match the son of ‘Abd Al-Muttalib in argument. Muhammad claims that we and these gods that we worship are fuel for Hell.” ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zab‘ari said: “By Allah, if I meet with him I will defeat him in argument. Ask Muhammad whether everyone that is worshipped instead of Allah will be in Hell with those who worshipped him, for we worship the angels, and the Jews worship ‘Uzayr, and the Christians worship Al-Masli, Isa bin Maryam.” Al-Walid and those who were sitting with him were amazed at what ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zab‘ari said, and they thought that he had come up with a good point. He said this to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, who said: “Everyone who likes to be worshipped instead of Allah will be with the ones who worshipped him, for indeed they are worshipping the Shaytan and whoever told them to worship him .» Then Allah revealed the words: 14 v ff&fcSE (4J 4 Verily, those for whom the good has preceded from Us, they will be removed far therefrom (Hell). They shall not hear the

&} iTherefore have no doubt concerning it. And follow Me (Allah)! This is the straight path} [43:63].
 ”* 1 ' What Ibn Az-Zab‘ari said was a serious mistake, because the Ayah was addressed to the people of Makkah concerning their worship of idols which were inanimate and could not think. It was a rebuke for their worship of them, so Allah said: . * . : y % i'- CK U_ {Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell!} How could this be applied to Al-Masli, Uzayr and others who did righteous deeds and did not accept the worship of those who worshipped them? 'r&Z v} iThe greatest terror will not grieve them,} It was said that this means death, as was narrated by ‘Abdur-Razzaq from Yahya bin Rab‘ah from ‘Ata.’ Or it was said that the greatest terror refers to the blast of the Trumpet, as Al-‘Awfi said narrating from Ibn ‘Abbas¹²¹ and Abu Sinan, Said bin Sinan Ash-Shaybani. This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir in his Tafsir. oji m&g>} iand the angels will meet them, (with the greeting:) "This is your Day which you were promised" .} meaning, the angels will greet them on the Day of Resurrection when they emerge from their graves with the words: 4”This is your Day which you were promised” .} meaning, hope for the best. llllc Lij /X-y jj' Uji> isjz, ff/} 111 Ibn Hisham 1 :384. At-Tabari 18:542.

506 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4104. And (remember) the Day when We shall roll up the heaven like a Sijill for books. As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do it. TheHeavenswillbe rolledupontheDayofResurrection Allah says: this will happen on the Day of Resurrection: 4And (remember) the Day when We shall roll up the heaven like a Sijillfor books.} This is like the Ayah -ill*If £ *>• iilt UjjS Cm iThey made not a just estimate ofAllah such as is due to Him. And on the Day of Resurrection the whole of the earth will be grasped by His Hand and the heavens will be rolled up in His Right Hand. Glorified be He, and High be He above all that they

associate as partners with Him!} [39:67] Al-Bukhari recorded that Nafi' reported from Ibn Tjmar that the Messenger of Allah said: v ..i 4^-Ul 0 j «On the Day of Resurrection, Allah will seize the earth and the heavens will be in His Right Hand .» This was recorded by Al-Bukhari, may Allah have mercy on him . 4J&J1 JZ} 4like a Sijill rolled up for books.} What is meant by Sijill is book. As-Suddi said concerning this Ayah: "As-Sijill is an angelwho is entrusted with the records; when a person dies, his Book (of deeds) is taken up to As-Sijill, and he rolls it up and puts it m Fath Al-Bari, 13:404.

away until the Day of Resurrection." But the correct view as narrated from Ibn 'Abbas is that As-Sijill refers to the record (of deeds).¹¹¹ This was also reported from him by 'Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-'Awfi. ¹²¹ This was also stated by Mujahid, Qatadah and others.*3 * This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, because this usage is well-known in the (Arabic) language. Based on the above, the meaning is: the Day when the heaven will be rolled up like a scroll. This is like the Ayah: iThen, when theij had both submitted themselves (to the will of Allah), and he had laid him prostrate on his forehead .fc [37:103] There are many more linguistic examples in this respect. Allah knows best. & in iis }ij 3 \32 tf) 4As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do it.) means, this will inevitably come to pass on the Day when Allah creates His creation anew. As He created them in the first place, He is surely able to re-create them. This must inevitably come to pass because it is one of the things that Allah has promised, and He does not break His promise. He is able to do that. Because He says: (S' iTruly, We shall do it.) Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: "The Messenger of Allah jg stood among us exhorting us, and said: J ^ Lis 'V/- si'/ sil£. > <iii Ji j !s Ul i0U IjJ.j "You will be gathered before Allah barefoot, naked and uncircumcised. m At-Tabari 18:543. At-Tabari 18:543. ' At-Jabari 18:543.

As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise bind- ing upon Us. Truly, We shall do iM¹¹¹ And he mentioned the entire Hadlth. It was also recorded in the Two Sahihs, and Al- Bukhari mentioned it in his Tafsir of this Ayah. j\$! & \$\$. \ oj, J£i And indeed We have written in Az-Za- biir after Adh-Dhikr that My righteous servants shall inherit the land.fr 4106. Verily, in this there is a plain Message for people who worship AllSh.fr 4107. And We have sent you (O Muhammad ah) not but as a mercy for the 'Alamln.fr The Earth willbe inheritedby the Righteous Allah tells us of His decree for His righteous servants who are the blessed in this world and in the Hereafter, those who will inherit the earth in this world and in the Hereafter. As Allah says: 111 Ahmad 1:235. Fath Al-B&ri 8 :292 , Muslim 4 :2194

•Z.t-S-81 i-reqBjL-iv (e| ^5=81 VreqBi-iv {z} 'Zt>S:8I UBqBj,-iv (l) 9ip osp? sbm siqx |E | (-qBnv MJJM si qoiqM (qvp^j-jy lump) qoog aqj jo Jsqqojq aqj si jytya-ypy pue 'jyiya-ypy jojjb aureo qoiq/w sqoog aqj sireau jrtqr>z-zy,, :pres piqBfnj^ ./qgjMBX sqj - ^OMQ-yPV pus 'priMBQ 01 pajB3A3j sbm qoiqM jBqj si mqvz-zy,, 'ptBS sjaqjo Pub qBpi?JB& 'ubsbh-iv 'tq,Bqg-qsv 'SBqqy, lel'5!00^ aMJ stream Jnqvz-zy,, 'pres piqBfnj^ lti(< /UB.jnf) <<qj pire jifuj aqj 'qtjJMBX aqj stream jtnqvz-zy, :pres ag i-°l)ltQ-ypV J9lfv -ujqvz-zy ui udpum dewy a/^ pddpui puy T f \0f fo jf :yvfiy aqj jnoqB J^Bqnp uiq pt.Bg paqsB :pres qsBui,yiV i*ma-HPV J3}fo JtJqvz~zy uf U9jjuai dewy pddpui puy^ f *? iifj> :s/{bs q?ltv ssBd oj amoo X]qB;iAui qtMq qjqj pus 'saajoag puBSMBq 3UIAIQ jo sqoog aqj tn papjooaj st siqj jsq; sn s[pi qBqy iS9 : ^S} 4m3l{i uafudsoip svy a/j ipiym uoiSipu uunp dsyovud oj ryuoypw dip uidyi }uvu8 pm dgy }vi{ } puv 'utdip duqfdq dsoip o) p pdjuvu8 dgy sv 'puvj dip ui

uoissdootis tudyt)uvj8 fyuwpdd pm dpi jvy) 'spddp poo8 snodjySu op puv dodipq oym nof\ 8uouw dsoip pdsuioud svy yvpy\$ f-p tr*i g g#^ 42r fr, \p- y?\ r^ e==rn' ""•S" " ,• ILS : Ot'] 4 ' y}-tofpuv}s pim sdssdiym dy) udy m fivQ dip uo puv d/p s tppom sup ui deidipq oym dsoip puv sud8udssdi/y uO snouopia dyviu pddpui pirn d/y['R\ud^ ih rrr x? \ * rffi %t&u& , \2ZVL\ i'UOibvp dewyoy m dsoip jo/ si puo (pdssdiq) dyi puv 'sfuvcuds spy fo spim duuioym ot d8v)udy v sv p sd8at8 a/j 's yvpy si ipuvd dyi 'ftpud/[\$ (Zl-VVd) UULSOl) ,Vtiiquy-iy 'll H^US60S

view of Zayd bin Aslam: "It is the First Book." Ath-Thawri said: "It is Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz." && ithatMy righteous servants shall inherit the land.} Mujahid said, narrating from Ibn 'Abbas, "This means, the land of Paradise." ' This was also the view of Abu Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ash-Shalai, Qatadah, As-Sud 1, Abu Salih, Ar-RabT bin Anas and Ath-Thawri (may Allah have mercy on them).2' ^^5 lijj 'ji* . i {Verily, in this (the Qur'an) there is a plain Messagefor people who toorship Allah.} means, 'in this Qur'an which We have revealed to Our servant Muhammad jg, there is a plain Message which is beneficial and is sufficient for a people who worship Allah. This refers to those who worship Allah in the manner which He has prescribed and which He loves and is pleased with, and they would rather obey Allah than foUow the Shayfan or their own desires. Muhammad^ is a Mercy to the Worlds {And We have sent you not but as a mercy for the *AlamTn .} Here Allah tells us that He has made Muhammad si a mercy to the 'Alamin, i.e., He sent him as a mercy for all of them (peoples), so whoever accepts this mercy and gives thanks for this blessing, will be happy in this world and m the Hereaf er But whoever rejects it and denies it, will lose out in this world and in the Hereafter, as Allah says: '&S\$ & ^ ^ if {Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of I 11 At-Tabari 18:549. 121 At-Tabari 18:549, 550.

577Surah 21. Al-Anbiua' (105-107) (Part-17) Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will bum, - and what an evil place to settle in!) [14:28-29] And Allah says, describing the Qur'an: oi JLC- iSay: "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them . They are those who are called from a placefar away [41:44] Muslim reports in his Sahlh: Ibn Abi 'Umar told us, Marwan Al-Fazari told us, from Yazld bin Klsan, from Ibn Abi Hazim that Abu Hurayrah said that it was said, "O Messenger of Allah, pray against the idolators." He said: Lwi # i UL*J «/ was not smt as a curse, rather I ivas sent as a mercy. This was recorded by Muslim.' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amr bin Abi Qurrah Al-Kindi said: "Hudhayfah was in Al-Mada'in and he was mentioning things that the Messenger of Allah sg had said. Hudhayfah came to Salman and Salman said: 'O Hudhayfah, the Messenger of Allah [would sometimes be angry and would speak accordingly, and would sometimes be pleased and would speak accordingly. I know that the Messenger of Allah addressed us and said: In ^ err^ y, j>-3 Uij» }y. 4* jrtiuij 1^~3 itjz d[ui liM y\ "Any man ofmy Ummah whom 1 have insulted or cursed when I was angry - for I am a man from among the sons ofAdam, and I get angry just as you do. But Allah has sent me as a Mercy to the Worlds, so I will make that [my anger] into Muslim 4 :2006

blessings for him on the Day ofResurrection ."h ' 1 ' This was also recorded by Abu Dawud from Ahmad bin Yunus from Za'idah.12 ' It may be asked: what kind of mercy do those who disbelieve in him get? The answer is what Abu Ja'far bin Jarir recorded from Ibn 'Abbas concerning the Ayah: 4And We have sent you not but as a mercyfor the 'Alamin .} He said, "Whoever believes in Allah and the

Last Day, mercy will be decreed for him in this world and in the Hereafter; whoever does not believe in Allah and His Messenger, will be protected from that which happened to the nations of earthquakes and stoning.”¹³ Ji 4jJ > V ^ > js dj L jU-Lj 4 '.I,OjA-i li Je iLulilf Giy ^i-1 yj 4108. Say: "It is revealed to me that your God is only one God. Will you then be Muslims?"} 4109. But if they him away say: "I give you a notice to be known to us all alike. And I know not whether that which you are promised is near or far."\$ 4110. "Verily, He knows that which is spoken aloud and He knows that which you conceal."} 4111. "And I know not, perhaps it may be a trial for you, and an enjoyment for a while."} 4112. He said:"My Lord! judge You in truth! Our Lord is the Most Gracious, Whose help is to be sought against that which you attribute!"} 111 Ahmad 5:437. '2 ' Abu Dawud 5 :45 . There is a similar Hadith recorded by Muslim no. 2601 131 At-Tabari 18:552.

513 Surah 21. Al-Anbiya (108-112) (Part-17) The main Objective of Revelation is that Allah be worshipped Allah commands His Messenger to say to the idolators: t3 sf i "It is revealed to me that your God is only one God. Will you then be Muslims?"} meaning, will you then follow that and submit to it? i"jy iBut if they turn away} means, if they ignore that to which you call them. J-i»r iSay : "I give you a notice to be known to us all alike..."} meaning, 'I declare that I am in a state of war with you as you are in a state of war with me. I have nothing to do with you just as you have nothing to do with me.' This is like the Ayah: QjUai U4 » V-3 V.. Ml .. i % iAnd if they belie you, say : "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!"} (10:41] 4tV*& 3~0\ jJb iCir fj ilf you fear treachery from any people, throw back (their covenant) to them (so as to be) on equal terms (that there will be no more covenant between you and them)} [8:58] which means: so that both you and they will know that the treaty is null and void. Similarly, Allah says here: T}!>- j-ii iBut if they turn away say : "I give you a notice to be known to us all alike..."} meaning, 'I have already informed you that I have nothing to do with you and you have nothing to do with me.'

No one knows when the Hour will come J Lfi} iAnd I know not whether that which you are promised (i.e.,

the Day of Resurrection) is near or far

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3679–3680]

meaning: 'it will inevitably come to pass, but I have no knowledge of whether it is near or far.' iVerily, He (Allah) knows that which is spoken aloud (openly) and He knows that which you conceal.} Allah knows the Unseen in its entirety; He knows what His creatures do openly and what they do secretly. He knows what is visible and what is concealed; He knows what is secret and hidden. He knows what His creatures do openly and in secret, and He will requite them for that, for both minor and major actions. J of)} iAnd I know not, perhaps it may be a trial for you, and an enjoyment for a while.} meaning, *1 do not know, perhaps it is a trial for you, and an enjoyment for a while.' Ibn Jarir said: 'perhaps that is being delayed for you as a test for you, and enjoyment for an allotted time.'¹¹¹ This was narrated by 'Awn from Ibn 'Abbas. And Allah knows best. £1 oj \$} iHe said: "My Lord! Judge You in truth!} means, judge between us and our people who disbelieve in the truth. Qatadah said: "The Prophets (peace be upon them) used to say: Jr dj cjj &j} i"Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth, for You are the Best of those who give judgment."} (7:89), Ml At-Tabari 18:554.

515 Surah 21. Al-Anbiud' (108-112) (Part-17) and the Messenger of Allah jg was commanded to say this too.” It was reported from Malik from Zayd bin Aslam that when the Messenger of Allah jg witnessed any fighting, he would say: && 4“My Lord! Judge You in truth!”} 40ur Lord is the Most Gracious, Whose help is to be sought against that which you attribute!} means, ‘against the various lies and fabrications that you utter, some of which are worse than others; Allah is the One Whose Help we seek against that.’

Surah 22: Al-Hajj

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3681–3706]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. J-fcJC L |>J> ffijL-lj* '\<t> iljj p £~~=,A> Lfjlj^ i-" . -.i.r r , •"& -('s Uj op/j L \$-*«• J—»- v *5 J==* t>== / , r.v /» / //> </<*'. > ^ j— Att^ t-J p-h 41. O mankind! Have Taqia of your Lord! Verily, the earthquake of the Hour is a terrible thing.} 42. The Day you shall see it, every nursing mother will forget her nursling, and every pregnant one will drop her load, and you shall see mankind as in a drunken state, yet they will not be drunk, but Allah's torment is severe .} The Hour Allah commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him, He informs them of the terrors of the Day of Resurrection which will come to them with its earthquakes and other horrors, as He says: 4t^Quii joVi 'j , 'U'Sij 4Wlien the earth is shaken with its (final) earthquake. And when the earth throws out its burdens.} 199:1-2] 4l“3i«i'j)* oojj if'. t&Ji JUh> Pfji¥ iAnd the earth and the mountains shall be removed from their places, and crushed with a single crushing. Then on that Day shall the (Great) Event befall.} [69:14-15] And;

517Siirah 22. Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) iWhen the earth will be shaken with a terrible shake. And the mountains will be powdered to dust.} [56 :4-5] It was said that this earthquake will come at the end of the ife span of this world, at the outset of the Hour. Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Alqamah commented on Allah’s saying, '-ca &&& Vj iVerily, the earthquake of the Hour (ofJudgement) is a terrible thing.} “Before the Hour.”*11 Others said that this refers to the terror, fear, earthquakes and chaos that will happen on the Day of Resurrection, in the arena (of Judgement), after the resurrection from the graves. This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, who took the following Hadiths as evidence: Imam Ahmad recorded that Imran bin Husayn said that when the Messenger of Allah was on one of his journeys and some of his Companions had fallen behind, he raised his voice and recited these two Ayat .be- *. "pi AidlJ' — L? } i" > \u •> \>- \tj <S_r* • (j'UI iJ/j l. '-» . 'V ' u-e iO mankind! Have Taqwa ofyour Lord! Verily, the earthquake of the Hour is a terrible thing. The Day you shall see it, every nursing mother will forget her nursling, and every pregnant one will drop her load, and you shall see mankind as in a drunken state, yet they will not be drunken, but Allah's torment is severe.} When his Companions heard that, they hastened to catch up with him, because they knew that he wanted to say something. When they reached him, he said: y <,j jjjCi Op fj j ijl lilli JjjjU : J_j£» ?jUJl C ! <J ijijl ^}1 U :J * I j jl>- \ jj &j ill l (j ij I (ys U1 At-Jabari 18:557.

“Do you know what Day that is? That is the Day when Adam will be called. His Lord will call him and will say: "O Adam, said forth (those of your progeny) who are to be salt to the Fire.” He will say, "O Lord, how many are to be sent to the Fire?” He will say, “From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will be in the Fire and one will be in Paradise.” His Companions were filled with despair

and stopped smiling. When he saw that, he said: iJe.J\$ J* J*. If) VI Li 4Be of good cheer and strive hard, for by the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, you will be counted with two creations who are of immense numbers, Ya'jiiij and Ma'jiiij, and those who have already died of the progeny of Adam and the progeny of Iblis .» Then they felt happier, and he said: i'jiJ j\ “Strive hard and be of good cheer, for by the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, in comparison to mankind you are like a mole on the flank of a camel or a mark on the foreleg of a beast. »|1 This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and by An-Nasal in the Book of Tafsir in their Sunans. At-Tirmidhi said, “It is Hasan Sahih.”<21 Another Version of this Hadith At-Tirmidhi recorded from “Imran bin Husayn that when the words, 4f*^==vj W' 40 mankind! Have Tactpva of your Lord.) Until His saying, ** Ahmad 4 :435. * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:12, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6:410.

519 Surah 22. Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) ibut Allah's torment is severe.} were revealed, the Prophet jg was on a journey, and he said: ill JX }y. j&f iijX/j Jill f>; j; Ulij jsUJL^J : JVJ Xi: li) 4^S U : Jti ijllJl IX iJl :fSV *5^ iJi j! *Do you know what Day that is?* They said, “Allah and His Messenger know best.” <He said: That is the Day on which Allah will say to Adam, "Send forth (those of your progeny) who are to be sent to the Fire." He will say, "O Lord, how many are to be sent to the Fire?" He will say, "From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will be in the Fire and one will be in Paradise." The Muslims started to weep, then the Messenger of Allah jg said: JiiJ U_> ijJidiJl oils' 'Vp aoJj jji lilUJl ja liijl •jrf? vU-J y&tiM (jjiJ iX'j\ ^ *Be close in your rank and be straight forward, for there was never any Prophet but there was a time of ignorance just before his advent, so the number will be taken from that time of ignorance, and if that is not enough, it will be made up from the hypocrites. A parable of yours in comparison to the other nations is that, you are like a mark on the foreleg of an animal, or a mole on the flank of a camel . Then he said, «/ hope that you will be a quarter of the people of Paradise. They said, “Allahu Akbari” Then he said, •aL»Jl vi-U I yyX L)f jXjS/ "/ hope that you will be a third of the people of Paradise . They said, “AUahu Akbar!” Then he said,

»/ hope that you will be half of the people of Paradise .» They said, uAllahu Akbar” Then he [the narrator] said, “I do not know if he said two-thirds or not.”* 11 This was also recorded by Imam Ahmad.|2) Then At-Tirmidhi also said, “This is a Hasan Sahih Hadith.” In his Tafsir, under this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said said, “The Prophet sg said: t .Ju l*_1j Ljj U : ^jj V ^ 'fj ^ < jdll ^ ^ «3il OJ P * * m * ' * P * ^ , r * * * P * • ^ *£ f P * * i oj*—jj - J 15 oljl — ijli ?jUJl ,J> Cj S& Jjj Jujjjl 4—rtj J^UJl “On i/ie Day o/ Resurrection, Allah will say: "O Adam." He will say, "At Your service, O Lord." Then a voice will call out : "Allah commands you to send forth from your progeny those who are destined for the Fire." He will say, "O Lord, iwho is destined for the Fire?" He will say, "From every thousand" - I think he said - "nine hundred and ninety-nine At that time every pregnant female will drop her load and children will be grey, and you shall see mankind as in a drunken state, yet they will not be drunken, but Allah's torment is severe.} That will be so difficult for mankind to bear that their faces will change. The Prophet jg said: ji±. j jUdi oyLlns j\ /jb\ j ;is>ui syLlns Jif iJS : Jli p X'f& * I Jil gj JJt M Jlj Jil>i : Jli P "Nine hundred and ninety-nine from Ya'juj and Ma'jitj, and one from you . Among mankind you are like a black hair on the Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:9. 121 Ahmad 4:432.

521 Surah 22. Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) side of a white bull, or a white hair on the side of a black bull . I hope that you will be one quarter of the people of Paradise.* We said “AUahu Akbar!” Then he said, «A

third of the people of Paradise .» We said, “AUahu Akbar!” Then he said, «One half of the people of Paradise .» We said: ‘Allahu Afcbari” 1 ’ Al-Bukhari also recorded this elsewhere. 12 ' It was also recorded by Muslim, and An-Nasal in his TafsirP The Hadiths and reports about the terrors of the Day of Resurrection are veiy many, and this is not the place to quote them all. iVerily, the earthquake of the Hour is a terrible thing.} means, a serious matter, a terrifying crisis, a horrendous event. This earthquake is what will happen to people when they are filled with terror, as Allah says: iThere, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking.} [33:11]. Then Allah says: iThe Day you shall see it, every nursing mother will forget her nursling,} means, she will be distracted by the horror of what she is seeing, which will make her forget the one who is the dearest of all to her and to whom she shows the most compassion. Her shock will make her neglect her infant at the very moment of breastfeeding, Allah says, ievery nursing mother}, and He did not say a mother who has an infant of breastfeeding age. 111 FathAl-Bari 8:295. 121 FathAl-Bari 6A40. ' Muslim 1 :201 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6 :409.

xJj rrt emtsw \n f • \ :f > r.m "Aw'i)Jjj LfAij O^Uf/L) ji==»£_U»j >* > «''' ^ >• // / V/#S*i ^ ./.» '-J-Cl"? ;>. ,i • ^ • " "A-i :c',-^i^ .*- . A^'.r: ^ ->tT irA-i/"> « them, will think, that they are drunk, Fakir Ibn Kathir i£Z# iher nursling> means, her nursing infant that has not yet been weaned. sK *& J*- £% i^S- iand every pregnant one will drop her load,} means, before the pre- gnancy has reached fullterm,becauseofthe intensityofthehorror. i*&. s& iand you shall see mankind as in a drunken state,} means, because of the severity of their situa- tion, when they will lose their minds, so that whoever sees i^jjs 4jH ^r>\±c. ^3> |Jk l>j} iyet they will not be drunken, but Allah's torment is severe.} \$£&*&|W^ J Jk \$ aU&* J* Sv> fi-irJ 'kfi <u5 •ij> 0“ <3. And among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge, andfallows every rebellious Shaytan.} i4. For him (the devil) it is decreed that whosoeverfallows him, he will mislead him, and will drive him to the torment of the Fire.}

523Surah 22. Al-Haii (3-4) (Part-17) Condemnation ofthe Followers ofthe Shaytan Allah condemns those who deny the Resurrection and who deny that Allah is able to restore life to the dead, those who turn away from that which Allah has revealed to His Prophets and, in their views - denial and disbelief - follow every rebellious Shaytan among men and Jinn. This is the state of the followers of innovation and misguidance, who turn away from the truth and follow falsehood, following the words of the leaders of misguidance who call people to follow innovation and their own desires and opinions. Allah says concerning them and their like, iAnd among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge,} meaning, without sound knowledge. iandfollows every rebellious Sltaytan . For him it is decreed.} Mujahid said, “This refers to that Shayfan .”1 11 meaning that is a matter written in the decree. iV ithat whosoeverfollows him,} and imitates him, j) Hjfi Ji-jo fc&} tyie will mislead him, and will drive him to the torment of the Fire.} means, he will mislead him in this world, and in the Hereafter he will drive him to the torment of the Fire, which is unbearably hot, painful and agonizing. As-Suddi reported that Abu Malik said, “This Ayah was revealed about An-Nadr bin Al-HarithJ21 This was also the view of Ibn JurayjJ3' ' Al-MuharrarAl-Wajtz 4 : 107 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :8 Af-Tabari 18:566.

U jf yl/ oi 4 b\ L di t* cj Jjjj jXj ijjPi /-ibtf JJdl2 P ^SE y J£ 4=~J^ ' { ^ ^ *4* <Jjii bp 5%4 lit; fJ-«i 4^=4 4*" Jjj £}^4 4 ,ju 4 iii ul jU'j “tg4 gp 4^@* <y 4jj 4i-»' iS «>* ^~*k\$ -4Lj !,-> 4> 4* ol> ii> Pyj cf £!> jp ./? 45. O mankind! If you are in doubt about the Resurrection, then verily, We have created you from

dust, then from a Nutfah, then from a clot then from a little lump of flesh - some formed and some unformed - that We may make (it) clear to you. And We cause whom We will to remain in the wombs for an appointed term, then We bring you out as infants, then (give you growth) that you may reach your age of full strength. And among you there is he who dies (young), and among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age, so that he knows nothing after having known. And you see the earth Hamidatan, but when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth).} 46. That is because Allah: He is the Truth, and it is He Who gives life to the dead, and it is He Who is able to do all things.} 47. And surely, the Hour is coming, there is no doubt about it; and certainly, Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.} Evidence of the Resurrection in the creation of Man and of Plants When Allah speaks of disbelief in the Resurrection, He also mentions the evidence of His power and ability to resurrect that is evident from the way He initiates creation. Allah says: o.j. 4^

525 Surah 22. Al-Hajj (5-7) (Part-17) 40 mankind! If you are in doubt about the Resurrection,} which means the time when souls and bodies will be raised up on the Day of Resurrection, %} 4 then verily. We have created you from dust,} meaning, "you were originally created from dust", which is what Adam, peace be upon him, was created from. 4f&> Ji 4 then from a Nutfah,} [32:8] meaning, then He made his offspring from semen of despised water. The Development of the Nutfah and Embryo in the Womb T/-*-* & *-> 7 4 then from a clot then from a little lump of flesh} if the Nutfah establishes itself in the woman's womb, it stays like that for forty days, then more material is added to it and it changes into a red clot, by the leave of Allah, and it remains like that for forty days. Then it changes and becomes a lump of flesh, like a piece of meat with no form or shape. Then it starts to take on a form and shape, developing a head, arms, chest, stomach, thighs, legs, feet and all its members. Sometimes a woman miscarries before the fetus is formed and sometimes she miscarries after it has formed. As Allah says: / _ "sy> *? /'i , / •£> 4 then from a little lump of flesh - some fanned and some unfanned} meaning, as you see. 4J^p di £2 C jUjP 4 that We may make (it) clear to you. And We cause whom We will to remain in the wombs for an appointed term,} meaning that sometimes the fetus remains in the womb and is not miscarried.

fj&tf isomeformed and some unformed,} Mujahid said, "This means the miscarried fetus, formed or unformed. When forty days have passed of it being a lump of flesh, then Allah sends an angel to it who breathes the soul into it and forms it as Allah wills, handsome or ugly, male or female. He then writes its provision, its allotted length of life and whether it is to be one of the blessed or the wretched." It was recorded in the Two Sahih's that Ibn Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah j&, who is the true and truly inspired one, told us: (j liii jL i>j£, pj Ju, j> jli jj» **jj : s'# vlliiJl vij lil dJw jU iJlJi jL iiJxl bjSZ j''' *Every one of you is collected in the womb of his mother for the first forty days, and then he becomes a clot for another forty days, and then a lump of flesh for another forty days. Then Allah sends an angel to write four words: He writes his provision, his deeds, his life span, and whether he will be blessed or wretched. Then he blows the soul into him. * "' Man's Development from Infancy to Old Age His saying; mpj i then We bring you out as infants,} means, weak in his body, hearing, sight, senses, stamina and mind. Then Allah gives him strength, gradually and causes his parents to treat him with tender kindness night and day. Allah says: \&k& i then (give you growth) that you may reach your age of full strength.} (i) Path Al-Bari 6:418, MusUm 4 :2036.

527 Surah 22. Al-Haii (5-7) (Part-17 meaning, his strength increases until he reaches the vitality and handsomeness of youth. 4 And among you there is he who dies,) means, when he is young and strong. 4 and among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age,) meaning advanced old age with its weakness in mind and body, in steady decline in comprehension, and disability to grasp. As Allah says: ifcl£ jip ££=*i} 4 so that he knows nothing after having known ~ t 1" •J* i^2iu. isM &} Jlp' yo b jiit iAllah is He Who created you in (a state of) weakness, then gave you strength after weakness, then after strength gave (you) weakness and grey hair. He creates what He wills. And it is He Who is the All-Knowing, the All-Powerful .} (30:54) Another Parable of the Resurrection from Plants 4; i* i Ja>} i And you see the earth Hd midatan,) This is another sign of the power of Allah to bring the dead back to life, just as He brings the dead, barren earth back to life, the lifeless earth in which nothing grows. Qatadah said, "(This means) the eroded, dusty earth." As-Suddi said, "Dead." 4^7+? fjj 4^=* ui ^A> CifjA ibut when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth) .} When Allah sends the rain upon it, it is stirred to life, that is,

528 Tafstr Ibn Kathir vegetation begins to grow and it comes alive after it was dead. Then it rises after the soil had settled, then it puts forth its different kinds of fruit and crops with all their varied colours, tastes, fragrances, shapes and benefits. Allah says: 4g0 Ji ^ A and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth).) meaning, beautiful in appearance and with delightful fragrances. 45b A That is because Allah : He is the Truth,) means, the Creator, the Controller, the One Who does as He wills. & J.&) i and it is He Who gives life to the dead,) means, just as He gives life to the dead earth and brings forth from it all these kinds of vegetation. .Jr\$£ 'tl30 l() A Verily, He Who gives it life, surely is able to give life to the dead. Indeed He is able to do all things.) [41:39] A Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is!) [36:82]. A^ri vjj ^ 0* ielill <f>) A And surely, the Hour is coming, there is no doubt about it;) meaning, it will inevitably come to pass. A/y& 4 £10\$ dJj) A and certainly, Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.) means, He will bring them back to life after they have become dust; He will create them anew after they have become nothing.

529 Surah 22. Al-Haii (8-10) (Part-17) tJ) Bdv>5 rrr .ZZ&ZS'SS tij* \$,4] 4iJ 4, alafr^li —i-ii'j 3ul;i! yj}, <UjjjcSz>-(j Jii' * ^ -,4^ _,*' i/ s'S * y ss > x)*'. s'l . »**?*>' >' ^ •*" »4jW» '0p jjj^ iy->-j jjLj J Ubi 4jJ^ >1 "sJi" \ > f > > n'V '*.fi < , . - s\$ / Z/" » / Z" *>> »> ' > ^>^r-';-f5 c> '< «z *- -c J*iu 'Ju'ojz-4-1^ ' ^02cSz*f <. ^ •>^rr.'. • >?{>' ' \ V.' \$j^g£Sfct-sgffipi < * //• / />* Z{ / y/ •• \ Jli / lili- ,^j) yjL* Ui Vi^y? 1A) r^j" <> sj-* 43' laLiii csji' 1^—< J» ^jlf & j£i\ il ii£ £fi f .. r >- i t;vArvujJ3y 4Afit/ he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who ivill give life to these bones after they are rotten and have be- come dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knower of every creation!" He Who pro- duces for you fire out of the green tree, when be- hold you kindle there- with.) [36:78-80]. And there are many similar Ayat. 4*3*4. ij." ^ -, ^ t jj fiy j^*j <4 CS o;LJ' i>y^ •": , ' ,< .- 7*.. 'u '>' -"•if '•' V »:. • »; - IaJ —iJj^J * •»Jar A» 1.4) AAiJjj ~ l3 ;W Ai) 4'l'v5^sj*5 J4i J_> 4'jj <8. And among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knoiuledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).) 49. Bending his neck in pride, and leading (others) too (far) astray from the path of Alldlt . For him tltere is disgrace in this ivorldly life, and on the Day ofResurrection We shall make him taste the torment ofburning.) 410. That is because of what your hands have sent forth, and verily, Allah is not unjust to servants.)

530 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Clarifying the State of the Leaders of the Innovators and Those Who lead People astray Allah has already told us about the ignorant imitators who are led astray: -h 4 cy 0\$m} iAnd among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge, and follows every rebellious Shaytan.} And here He tells us about those who call others to misguidance, the leaders of disbelief and innovation: iAnd among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).} meaning, with no correct rational thought, and no clear transmitted text; what they say is based only on their opinions and whims. Allah's saying, iBending his neck in pride,} Ibn 'Abbas and others said, "Too proud to follow the truth when he is called to it." 1 ! Mujahid, Qatadah and Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam: 4*O&e iBending his neck in pride,} means, twisting his neck, i.e., turning away from the truth to which he is called, bending his neck out of pride and arrogance. This is like the Ayat. iAnd in Musa, when We sent him to Fir'awn with a manifest authority. But (Fir'awn) turned away along with his hosts} 151:38-39], UjA.^al Jvji ;J1 cJj Jj-il U d] IjLal fX •i'p'.oii II] At-Tabari 18:573.

4And when it is said to them: "Come to what Allah has sent down and to the Messenger," you see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion [4:611, ojXju ,v4^ly & ly/ien if is said to them : "Come, so that the Messenger of Allah may ask forgiveness from Allah for you," they twist their heads, and you would see them turning away their faces in pride.) [63:5], And Luqman said to his son: iv&i &L %) 4And turn not your face away from men with pride) [31:18] meaning, do not turn away from them in an arrogant manner. And Allah says: ^£ \>\$) 4And when Our verses are recited to him, he turns away in pride) [31:7], £ j-j?*) 4atid leading (others) too (far) astray from the path of Allah.) This either refers to those who are stubborn, or it means that the person who does this has been created like this so that he will be one of those who lead others astray from the path of Allah. Then Allah says: 4For him there is disgrace in this worldly life,) meaning, humiliation and shame, such as when he is too arrogant to heed the signs of Allah, so Allah will send humiliation upon him in this world and will punish him in this world, before he reaches the Hereafter, because this world is all he cares about and all he knows. c~>J» \li Jjvie f-'ef fj> fj*iA)) iand on the Day of Resurrection We shall make him taste the

torment of burning. That is because of what your hands have sent forth,> means, this will be said to him by way of rebuke. \$J~.fi Jll) ill \$j} iand verily, Allah is not unjust to the servants .} This is like the Ayat: <3i ,ji '4-fj jy f 'tv' ^ tjj^} 1 > A**** // / j ^ * s •• } ^ X -4^ >lij U IJCft uj. ^isSStJl 4(7t wi// be said:) "Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire, Then pour over his head the torment of boiling water. Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous! Verily, this is that whereof you used to doubt!"} [44:47-50] V >rs\ *• v **. •' >>• ' ' -vS-^ *-*)**' jU»' jy- y/> ^ - oi* .Xju jj-U' sJ > ; > r v«*fr i'&t' ,•{, { - ' t :r >-'.t >>.' " , :- . - :f > r * ,r -> *•>'.? s, », >- J*/^ <.v . _yb Ci-U'j fOuu* j Uj fj—~ Jly, 4' 412 And among mankind is he who worships Allah as it were upon the edge: if good befalls him, he is content therewith; but if a Fitnah strikes him, he turns back on his face. He loses both this world and the Hereafter. That is the evident loss.} ill. He calls besides Allah unto that which can neither harm him nor profit him. That is a straying far away.} il3. He calls unto him whose harm is nearer than his profit; certainly an evil Mawla and certainly an evil 'Ashir!} The meaning of worshipping Allah as it were upon the edge Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: iupon the edge} means, in doubt.' ' Others said that it meant m At-Tabari 18:576.

533 Surah 22. Al-Haii (U-13) (Part-17 on the edge, such as on the edge or side of a mountain, i.e., (this person) enters Islam on the edge, and if he finds what he likes he will continue, otherwise he will leave. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said: iAnd among mankind is he who worships Allah as it were upon the edge.} “People would come to Al-Madlnah (to declare their Islam] and if their wives gave birth to sons and their mares gave birth to foals, they would say, This is a good religion,’ but if their wives and their mares did not give birth, they would say, This is a bad religion.” Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “One of them would come to Al-Madlnah, which was a land that was infected with a contagious disease. If he remained healthy there, and his mare foaled and his wife gave birth to a boy, he would be content, and would say, ‘I have not experienced anything but good since I started to follow this religion.” S jiXJ ibut if a Fitnah strikes him}, Fitnah here means affliction, i.e., if the disease of Al-Madinah befalls him, and his wife gives birth to a babe girl and charity is delayed in coming to him, the Shaytan comes to him and says: T3y Allah, since you started to follow this religion of yours, you have experienced nothing but bad things,’ and this is the Fitnah.”*2 * This was also mentioned by Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ibn Jurayj and others among the Salaf when explaining this Ayah.*3 ‘ Mujahid said, concerning the Ayah: ihe turns back on his face.} “(This means), he becomes an apostate and a disbeliever.”*4 ‘ <’ FathAl-Bari 8:296. ‘ At-Jabari 18:575. ‘ At-Tabari 18:576. At-Jabari 18:576.

4He loses both this world and the Hereafter means, he does not gain anything in this world. As for the Hereafter, he has disbelieved in Allah the Almighty, so he will be utterly doomed and humiliated. So Allah says: itxJSi 101 ji iThat is the evident loss.), i.e., the greatest loss and the losing deal. V L n •J V L» Oi 4He calls besides Allah unto that which can neither harm him nor profit him .) means, the idols, rivals, and false gods which he calls upon for help, support and provision - they can neither benefit him nor harm him. iLfii i&t >^ iThat is a strayingfar away.) i t </.1 >>. Vi vi>»' '•>» o 4He calls unto him whose harm is nearer than his profit;) means, he is more likely to harm him than benefit him in this world, and in the Hereafter he will most certainly cause him harm. dip" pJ» 4certainly an evil Mawla and certainly an evil Ashir!) Mujahid said, “This means the idols. The meaning is: “How evil a friend is this one upon whom he calls instead of Allah as a helper and supporter.” 4and certainly an evil ‘Ashir!) means the one with whom one mixes and spends one’s time. m At-Tabari 18:579.

535 Surah 22. Al-Haij (14-16) (Part-17) & if 5! J&Sn o;^ ijLS&C £#^ if k> ^ V424. Truly, Allah will admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds to Gardens underneath which rivers flow. Verily, Allah does what He wills.} The Reward ofthe Righteous The mention of the misguided who are doomed is followed by mention of the righteous who are blessed. They are those who believe firmly in their hearts and confirm their faith by then- actions, doing all kinds of righteous deeds and avoiding evil actions. Because of this, they will inherit dwellings in the lofty ranks of the gardens of Paradise. So Allah tells us that He sends those astray and guides these, and says: iVerily, Allah does what He wills.} £2 p £*# S\^ }A:\$j c& u if & * if% c Y4 £’M 425. Whoever thinks that Allah will not help him in this world and in the Hereafter, let him stretch out a rope to the ceiling and let him strangle himself. Then let him see whether his plan will remove that whereat he rages!} 426. Thus have We sent it down as clear Ayat, and surely, Allah guides whom He wills.} Allah will definitely help His Messenger^ Ibn ‘Abb^s said, “Whoever thinks that Allah will not help Muhammad^ in this world and the Hereafter, let him stretch out a rope 4to the ceiling} to the ceiling in his house.

and let him strangle himself. let him hang himself with it.” This was also the view of Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, ‘Ata’, Abu Al- Jawza’, Qatadah and others. 12 The meaning is: whoever thinks that Allah will not support Muhammad and His Book and His Religion, let him go and kill himself if it annoys him so much. For Allah will most certainly help and support him. Allah says: *clif J \pa i* Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth.} (40:51]. Allah says here: *4-b^i U j* pi}}* iThen let him see whether his plan ivill remove that whereat he rages!} As-Suddi said, “Meaning, in the case of Muhammad 3&”13 ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani said, “Let him see whether that will cure the rage he feels in his heart.” 477ms have We sent it down the Qur’an. *4o£J c£\l}* ias clear Aydt,} clear in its wording and its meaning, evidence from Allah to mankind. *44vji ce iSp \$>}* iand surely, Allah guides whom He wills.} He sends astray whomsoever He wills and He guides whomsoever He wills, and He has complete wisdom and definitive proof in doing so. 111 At-Tabari 18:581. 121 At-Tabari 18:580-583. 131 Ar-Razi 13:15.

4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} [21:23]. Because of His wisdom, mercy, justice, knowledge, dominion and might, no one can overturn His ruling, and He is swift in bringing to account. *Att' uu)lj [y*4^ uyJ' o\$ -4ri tjT tk o]* 17. Verily, those ivho believe, and those who are Jezvs, and the Sabians, and the Christians, and the Majus, and those who ivorship others besides Allah; truly, Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection. Verily, Allah is over all things a Witness.} Allah will judge between the Sects on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about the followers of these various religions, the believers (Muslims) and others such as the Jews and Sabians. We have already seen a definition of them in Surat Al- Baqarah[11 and have noted how people differ over who they are. There are also the Christians, Majus and others who worship others alongside Allah. Allah will *4'£-\$ (ji .*4^? J~"d^ ij* judge between them on the Day of Resurrection} with justice; He will admit those who believed in Him to Paradise and will send those who disbelieved in Him to Hell, for He is a Witness over their deeds, and He knows all that they say and all that they do in secret, and conceal in their breast. *3Qr?J vS1*— J j jt \$c%^ ^ ^ sM 4%mc&>\$ si m* Surat Al-Baqarah 2 :62

539Surah 22. Al-Hajj (17-18) (Part-17) prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them} [41:37]. In the Two Sahths it was recorded that Abu Dharr said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said to me, *ail jai* «Do you know where this sun goes?” I said, ‘Allah and His Messenger know best.’ He said, *of : l*J Jli’ M - ‘i * -* •: *C^U JL JL> »/f* goes (se/sj and prostrates beneath the Throne, then it awaits the command. Soon it will be told, “Go back the way whence you came.”” Ibn ‘Abbas said, “A man came and said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, I saw myself in a dream last night, as if I was praying behind a tree. I prostrated, and the tree prostrated when I did, and I heard it saying, “O Allah, write down a reward for me for that, and remove a sin from me for that, store it with You for me and accept it from me as You accepted from Your servant Dawud.’ ” Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Messenger of Allah jg recited an Ayah mentioning a prostration, then he prostrated, and I heard him saying the same words that the man had told him the tree said.” This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, and Ibn Hibb&n in his Sahib.12 ‘iAd-Dawabb} means all the animals. It was reported in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad that the Messenger of Allah jg forbade using the backs of animals as platforms for speaking, for, perhaps the one who was being ridden was better and remembered Allah more than the one who was riding.'3' iand many of mankind} means, they prostrate willingly, 111 Fath Al-B6ri 6 :342 , Muslim 1 :138. 121 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3 : 18 1 , Ibn Majah 1 :334 , Ibn Hibb&n 4:191. 131 Ahmad 3:441.

541 Surah 22. Al-Hajj (19-22) (Part-17) j>r^J i)\$j ^ 'Cut *? /" f> > **,£.* / \$ \$^LJj (_-&i ^ %»*i rrt &mm %, -" , ;>^;r . ,-. • *£ 2l ilia Ly^— ^iu/y ><• x / <>/ • j> y s < /iy **1 ^ lSf*dJjCAt^lio)'_)1? •>L*OjJl_J 1>(jUj l Qp >> <0)1^*jlljt^sa iyjiit , v^tat^Jlt iulojl_A2'Up -U-pi A^LjSjy_y c >r,""T>-f - > •""»> i<"n .\"*-'*fc>* _Pn-^(>5-4JLj 4JU'o-^Cr*j<—, *Jj“Ac*c<3>'-<!'~L> * l/^ • «» / »^ / / yV A "V/ / » j.>.<7l-»-l^l« >^»*»-)j'j^a^Up§ AiaU^Jjtio^Olllo^ > .. -. . . ^,r (»{->*j s?y oi v-^j oj J) l> 'A* ^ r ^L # (gijij J L)JL^ I ai ** - "a ,.1), ^ ,--.(> 4 -< - -.. •>:>' Vj y-~?' ^ Vt 4'^o^i' v'-w 'AAj 429. These two opponents dispute with each other about their Lord; then as for those who disbelieved, garments offire will be cut out for them, boiling water will be poured down over their heads.} 420. With it will melt (or vanish away) what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins.} 421. And for them are hooked rods of iron.} 422. Every time they seek to get away therefrom, from anguish, they will be driven back therein, and (it will be) said to them "Taste the torment of bunting!"

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3706–3726]

It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Dharr swore that this Ayah - °(*jO iThese two opponents dispute with each other about their Lord;} was revealed concerning Hamzah and his two companions, and Utbah and his two companions, on the day of Badr when

they came forward to engage in single combat. This is the wording of Al-Bukhari in his Tafsir of this Ayah) Then Al- Bukhari recorded that ‘Ali bin Abi Jalib said, “I will be the first one to kneel down before the Most Merciful so that the dispute may be settled on the Day of Resurrection.” Qays (sub-narrator) said, “Concerning them the Ayah was revealed: rjy j i iThese two opponents dispute with each other about their Lord;} He (Qays) said, “They are the ones who came forward (for single combat) on the day of Badr: ‘Ali, Hamzah and Tlbaydah vs., Shaybah bin Rabl'ah, Utbah bin Rabl'ah and Al-Walld bin ‘Utbah.” This was reported only by Al-Bukhari.¹² Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid commented on this Ayah, “Such as the disbeliever and the believer disputing about the Resurrection.” According to one report Mujahid and ‘Ata’ commented on this Ayah, “This refers to the believers and the disbelievers.” The view of Mujahid and ‘Ata’ that this refers to the disbelievers and the believers, includes all opinions, the story of Badr as well as the others. For the believers want to support the religion of Allah, while the disbelievers want to extinguish the light of faith and to defeat the truth and cause falsehood to prevail. This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and it is good. The Punishment of the Disbelievers <>* vQ pi => cjili i then as for those who disbelieved, garments offire will be cut out for them,} meaning, pieces of fire will be prepared for them. Said bin Jubayr said: “Of copper, for it is the hottest of things when it is heated.”¹³ Fath Al-Bari 8 :297 , Muslim 4 :2323 Fath Al-Bari 8 :297. ,3! At-Tabari, 18:590.

j 1 *> 4^5(1 > > A* 4 AY ";^v [»-•; • (Vf-Jv & ^r-^ir i boiling water will be poured down over their heads. With it will melt (or vanish away) what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins.} meaning, when the boiling water -which is water that has been heated to the ultimate degree- is poured down over their heads. Ibn Jarir recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg| said: » / - >, t ,, *4 .iaCi ,j1p jj ajl5 L15" ilij l I j&J £JL O La «77ie boiling water will be poured over their heads and will penetrate their skulls until it reaches what is inside, and what is inside will melt until it reaches their feet. This is

the melting, then he will be restored to the state he was before . »• 11 It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said it is Hasan Sahih . This was also recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim, who then recorded that ‘Abdullah bin As-Sariy said, “The angel will come to him, carrying the vessel with a pair of tongs because of its heat. When he brings it near to his face, he will shy away from it. He will raise a hammer that he is carrying and will strike his head with it, and his brains will spill out, then he will pour the brains back into his head. This is what Allah says in the Ayah: iWith it will melt what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins. iAndfor them are hooked rods of iron.} At-Tabari 18:591. ^ TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :301 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6:21.

545Surah 22. Al-Haii (23-24) (Part-17) The Reward ofthe Believers When Allah tells us about the state of the people of Hell - we seek refuge with Allah from that state of punishment, vengeance, burning and chains - and the garments of fire that have been prepared for them, He then tells us about the state of the people of Paradise - we ask Allah by His grace and kindness to admit us therein. He tells us: ,c.'A .- AL }Truly, Allah zoill admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds, to Cardens underneath which riversflow,} means, these rivers flow throughout its regions, beneath its trees and palaces, and its inhabitants direct them to go wherever they want. 4^+^ . } iwherein they zoill be adorned - with jewelry - Jjilj yli CK iivith bracelets of gold and pearls} means, on their arms, as the Prophet said in the agreed-upon Hadltlv. -UUJI ^Lj 8 ‘The jezoelry of the believer [in Paradise] will reach as far as his Wudu' reached .»|1! iand their garments therein will be of silk.} in contrast to the garments of fire worn by the inhabitants of Hell, the people of Paradise will have garments of silk, Sundus and Istabracf2 * fine green silk and gold embroidery, as Allah says: *j*~\~* <w_>v-i og iT> ^3 if ui iTheir garments zoill be of green Sundus, and Istabraq. They ^ FathAl-Bari 10:398, Muslim 1 :219. See the Tafsrof Surat Al-Kahf 19:31, and Surat Al-Insan 76:21-22.

547Surah 22. Al-Haii (23-24) (Part-17 But only the saying of, "Peace! Peace! (Salomon! Salomon!) ." } [56:25-26] They will be guided to a place in which they will hear good speech. iTherein they shall be met with greetings and the word ofpeace and respect.} [25:75], unlike the scorn which will be heaped upon the people of Hell by way of rebuke, when they are told: i'Taste the torment ofburning!"} i+Ji d\b&} iand they are guided to the path ofHim Who is Worthy of all praises.} to a place in which they will give praise to their Lord for all His kindness, blessings and favors towards them, as it says in the Sahih Hadith: <>2JI US j^JJ» «77iei/ will be inspired with words of glorification and praise, just as they are inspired with breath. n* 11 Some scholars of Tafsir said that the Ayah, iAnd they are guided unto goodly speech} refers to the Qur'an; and it was said that it means La ilaha illalldh or words of remembrance prescribed in Islam. And the Ayah: 4^- dl b^j} iand they are guided to the path ofHim Who is Worthy of all praises.} means, the straight path in this world. These interpretations do not contradict that mentioned above. And Allah knows best. m Muslim 4:2180, 2181.

Surah 22 it, although the believers have more right than anyone else to go there. The structure of this phrase is like that to be found in the Ayah: Sii ir*' iTftose who believed, and whose hearts find rest in the remembrance of Allah, verily, in the remembrance of Allah do heartsfind rest.> [13 :28] Not only are they believers, but their hearts also find rest in the remembrance of Allah. The Issue ofrenting Houses inMakkah iwhich We have made (open) to (all) men, the dweller in it and the visitorfrom the country are equal there meaning that they prevent people from reaching Al-Masjid Al- Haram, which

Allah has made equally accessible to all in Sharfah, with no differentiation between those who live there and those who live far away from it. The dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there, Part of this equality is that everyone has equal access to all parts of the city and can live there, as ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas concerning the Ayah: *“The dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there,”* He [Ibn ‘Abbas] said: “Both the people of Makkah and others can stay in Al-Masjid Al-Haram,”* 1 ‘The dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there I 1 ‘ At-Tabari 18:596.

Mujahid said, “The people of Makkah and others are equally allowed to stay there.” This was also the view of Abu Salih, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Sabit and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. ‘Abdur-Razzaq narrated from Ma'mar, from Qatadah who said: “Its own people and others are equal therein.” This is the issue about which Ash-Shafil and Ishaq bin Rahwayh differed in the Masjid of Al-Khayf, when Ahmad bin Hanbal was also present. Ash-Shafil was of the opinion that the various parts of Makkah can be owned, inherited and rented, and he used as evidence the Hadith of Usamah bin Zayd who said, “I said, O Messenger of Allah, will you go and stay tomorrow in your house in Makkah?” He said, “Has ‘Aqil left us any property?” Then he said, “A disbeliever does not inherit from a Muslim and a Muslim does not inherit from a disbeliever.” This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahibs. 1 11 He also used as evidence the report that Umar bin Al-Khattab bought a house in Makkah from Safwan bin Umayyah for four thousand Dinars, and made it into a prison. This was also the view of Tawtis and ‘Amr bin Dinar. Ishaq bin Rahwayh was of the opinion that they (houses in Makkah) could not be inherited or rented. This was the view of a number of the Salaf, and Mujahid and ‘Ata’ said likewise. Ishaq bin Rahwayh used as evidence the report recorded by Ibn Majah from ‘Alqamah bin Nadlah who said, “The Messenger of Allah jg, Abu Bakr and “Umar died, and nobody claimed any property in Makkah except the grazing animals. Whoever needed to live there would take up residence there, and whoever did not need to live there would let others take up residence there. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said, “It is not allowed to sell or rent the houses of Makkah.” He also said, narrating from Ibn Jurayj: “Ata’ would not allow people to ^ Al-Bukhari no. 6764, Muslim 1614. Ibn Majah 3107.

551 Surah 22. Al-Haii (25) (Part-17) charge rent in the Haram, and he told me that Umar bin Al-Khattab did not allow people to put gates on the houses of Makkah because the pilgrims used to stay in their courtyards. The first person to put a gate on his house was Suhayl bin ‘Amr. Tjmar bin Al-Khattab sent for him about that and he said, “Listen to me, O Commander of the faithful, I am a man who engages in trade and I want to protect my back.” He said, Then you may do that.’ ” ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded from Mujahid that ‘Umar bin Al-Khattab said, “O people of Makkah, do not put gates on your houses, and let the bedouins stay wherever they want.” * He said: Ma'mar told us, narrating from someone who heard ‘Ata’ say about the Ayah, *“The dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there,”* “They may stay wherever they want.” Ad-Daraqutni recorded a saying reported from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr: “Whoever charges rent for the houses of Makkah, consumes fire.”*2 Imam Ahmad took a middle path, according to what his son Salih narrated from him, and he said, “They may be owned and inherited, but they should not be rented, so as to reconcile between all the proofs.” And Allah knows best. A Warning to Those Who want to commit Evil Actions in the Haram and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong, him We shall cause to taste from a painful torment.} 4 or to do wrong,} means, he aims deliberately to do wrong, and it is not the matter of

misunderstanding. As Ibn Jurayj said narrating from Ibn 'Abbas, "This means someone whose actions are intentional."*3 *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur4 :633 * Ad-Daraqutni 2 :300 ' At-Tabari 18:601

--- Tafsir Ibn Kathir 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The evil action of Shirk. "1 Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "The evil action is allowing in the Haram what Allah has forbidden, such as mistreating and killing, whereby you do wrong to those who have done you no wrong and you kill those who have not fought you. If a person does this, then he deserves to suffer a painful torment."121 ior to do wrong,} Mujahid said, "To do some bad action therein. This is one of the unique features of Al-Haram, that the person who is about to do some evil action should be punished if this is his intention, even if he has not yet commenced the action." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded in his Tafsir that 'Abdullah (i.e., Ibn Mas'ud) commented about the Ayah, 4_» J.j} 4and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} "If a man intends to do some evil action therein, Allah will make him taste a painful torment. "3 * This was also recorded by Ahmad.*4 * I say, [its] chain is Sahih according to the conditions of Al-Bukhari, and it is more likely Mawquf than Marfa'. And Allah knows best. Said bin Jubayr said, "Insulting a servant and anything more than that is (counted as) wrongdoing." Habib bin Abi Thabit said: iand whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} "Hoarding (goods) in Makkah." This was also the view of others. 4JjL jfcSjL 7 iand whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} At-Tabari 18:600. At-Tabari 18:600. * At-Tabari 18:601 * Ahmad 1 :428

553 Surah 22. Al-Haai (26-27) (Part-17) Ibn 'Abbas said, "This was revealed about 'Abdullah bin Unays. The Messenger of Allah jg sent him with two men, one of whom was a Muhajir and the other from among the Ansar. They began to boast about their lineages and 'Abdullah bin Unays got angry and killed the Ansari. Then he reverted from Islam (became an apostate) and fled to Makkah. Then these words were revealed concerning him: iand whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} meaning, whoever flees to Al-Haram to do evil actions, i.e., by leaving Islam." These reports indicate some meanings of the phrase "evil actions", but the meaning is more general than that and includes things which are more serious. Hence when the owners of the Elephant planned to destroy the House (the Ka'bah), Allah sent against them birds in flocks, iStriking them with stones of SijjilJ21 And He made them like (an empty field of) stalks (of which the corn has been eaten up by cattle).} [105:4-5], means He destroyed them and made them a lesson and a warning for everyone who intends to commit evil actions there. Hence it was reported in a Hadith that the Messenger of Allah 3S said: ^ j* 1 'H «77iis House zwill be attacked by an army, then when they are in a wide open space, the first of them and the last of them ivill be sivalloved up by the earth .»|3' V o' JS & >p) 4 .'y J* iljf. The report is recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Its chain has some deficiency in it ' See volume five, the explanation of Surah Hud (1 1 :82). 131 Fath Al-Bari 4 :397

426. And (remember) when We showed Ibrahim the site of the House (saying): "Associate not anything with Me, and sanctify My House for those who circumambulate it, and those who stand up (for prayer), and those who bow and make prostration (in prayer);" 427. And proclaim to mankind the Hajj (pilgrimage). They will come to you on foot and on every lean camel, they will come from every Fajj 'Amiq.} BuildingoftheKa'bahand the Proclamation ofthe Hajj This is a rebuke to those among Quraysh who worshipped others than Allah and joined partners with Him in the place which from the outset had

been established on the basis of Tawhid. and the worship of Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. Allah tells us that He showed Ibrahim the site of the 'Atiq House, i.e., He guided him to it, entrusted it to him and granted him permission to build it. Many scholars take this as evidence to support their view that Ibrahim was the first one to build the House and that it was not built before his time. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Dharr said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, which Masjid was the first to be built?' He said, "Al-Masjid Al-Haram .» I said, Then which?' He said, Bayt Al-MaqdisJ I said, 'How long between them?' He said, n -' , f,, "Forty yearsJ"111 And Allah says: ijiii UjUU yJ. Jjt 4Verily, thefirst House (ofworship) appointedfor mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing [3:96] until the end of following two Ayat. Allah says: ^ FathAl-Bari 6:469, Muslim 1 :370.

ijr?. J i', 4<wid We commanded Ibrahim and Ismd'il that they should purify My House for those who are circumambulating it, or staying (I'tikdf), or bowing or prostrating themselves.> [2:125] And Allah says here: . . *> : »\ iAssociate not anything with Me,} meaning, "Build it in My Name Alone.' i'S iand sanctify My House} Qatadah and Mujahid said, "And purify it from Shirk ^=ihj juASti} ifor those who circumambulate it, and those who stand up, and those who bow, and make prostration (in prayer)} means, "and make it purely for those who worship Allah Alone, with no partner or associate.' What is meant by "those who circumambulate it" is obvious, since this is an act of worship that is done only at the Ka"bah and not at any other spot on earth. iand those who stand up} means, in prayer. Allah says: iand those ivho bow, and make prostration .} Tawafand prayer are mentioned together because they are not prescribed together anywhere except in relation to the House. Tawaf is done around the Ka'bah and prayer is offered facing its direction in the majority of cases, with a few exceptions, such as when one is uncertain of the direction of the Qiblah, during battle and when praying optional prayers while traveling. And Allah knows best. m At-Tabari 18 :604

iAnd proclaim to mankind the Hajj} meaning, 'announce the pilgrimage to mankind and call them to perform pilgrimage to this House which We have commanded you to build.' It was said that Ibrahim said: "O Lord, how can I convey this to people when my voice will not reach them?" It was said: "Call them and We will convey it." So Ibrahim stood up and said, "O mankind! Your Lord has established a House so come on pilgrimage to it." It is said that the mountains lowered themselves so that his voice would reach all the regions of the earth, and those who were still in their mothers' wombs and their fathers' loins would hear the call. The response came from everyone in the cities, deserts and countryside, and those whom Allah has decreed will make the pilgrimage, until the Day of Resurrection: "At Your service, O Allah, at Your service." This is a summary of the narrations from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayl * and others among the Salaf. And Allah knows best. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir and by Ibn Abi Hatim at length. iThey will come to you on foot and on every lean camel,} This Ayah was used as evidence by those scholars whose view is that Hajj performed on foot by those who are able, is better than Hajj performed riding, because the phrase "on foot" is mentioned first, and because it is an indication of their keenness and resolve. Waki' narrated from Abu Al-TJmays from Abu Halhalah from Muhammad bin Ka*b that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I do not regret anything except for the fact that I wish I had performed Hajj on foot, because Allah says, 2}t} iThey will come to you on foot}. But the majority are of the view that performing Hajj while riding is better, following the example of the Messenger of Allah jg, because he performed Hajj riding, although his physical ability was sound. m At-Tabari 18:605, 606, 607. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :35

557 Surah 22. Al-Hajj (28-29) (Part-17) 4g\$ o-, djii¥ ithey will come from every Fajft means every route, as Allah says: Ijj iand We placed therein Fijdj for them to pass\$> [21:31]. 4^} i'Anriq} means distant. This was the view of Mujahid, 'Ata', As-Suddi, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayan, Ath-Thawri and others. 1 11 This Ayah is like the Ayah in which Allah tells us how Ibrahim prayed for his family, ink rro^ SUj&S JOxUj ijC- ^_Ls <^pjd -Si Cp jyjtJLJ ^US^=> . "if '--tT a> (>*j (iJUb *O-i-JV at' 4So fill some hearts among men with love towards them£ [14:37], There is no one among the Muslims who does not long to see the Ka'bah and perform Tawaf, people come to this spot from every comer of the world. j“ p-4Xu £ d* Ti «i' ^ O-itjL jA>^: b ^28. Tlmt they may witness things that are of benefit to them, |il At-Tabari 18:608.

and mention the Name of Allah on appointed days, over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them. Then eat thereof and feed therewith the poor having a hard time.'} i29. Then let them complete their prescribed duties and perform their vows, and circumambulate the 'Atiq House.} Hajj Brings benefits in this World and in the Hereafter iff iThat they may witness things that are of benefit to them,} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Benefits in this world and in the Hereafter." Benefits of the Hereafter includes Allah's pleasure. Material benefits in this world include sacrificial animals and trade."1 11 This was also the view of Mujahid and others, that the benefits come in this world and in the Hereafter.'21 This is like the Ayah: iThere is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord} [2 :198]. iand mention the Name of Allah on appointed days, over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them (for sacrifice).} Shubah and Hushaym narrated from Abu Bishr from Said from Ibn 'Abbas, "The appointed days are the ten days (of Dhul-Hijjah).3 ' Al-Bukhari narrated this with a disconnected chain in a manner denoting his approval of it.' Something similar was narrated from Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, Mujahid, Qatadah, 'Ata', Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Ad- Dahhak, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and Ibrahim An-Nakhal.'5' Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that the Prophet said: At-Tabari 18:609. Af-Tabari 18:609. Fath Al-Bari 2 : 531 , At-Tabari 4 :208 Fath Al-Bari 2:531. At-Tabari 18:610, Ar-Razi, 23:26.

'•i* Jt J-4»' Jt t*' aNo deeds are more virtuous than deeds done on these days .» They said, "Not even Jihad for the sake of Allah?" He said, gr'jt i"" Jcr- «Not even Jihad for the sake of Allah, unless a man goes out risking himself and his wealth for the sake of Allah, and does not come back with anything.^ Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Tjmar said, "The Messenger of Allah g£ said: jlii i jij j5i w—>-1 'jj jil Xjp jviip u® «77iere are no days that are greater before Allah or in which deeds are more beloved to Him than these ten days, so increase your Tahiti, Takbtr, and Talmud during these days .»(3 ' Al-Bukhari said, "Ibn 'Umar and Abu Hurayrah used to go out in the marketplace during the ten days and say Takbtr, and the people would say Takbtr when they said Takbtr.'^ These ten days include the day of 'Arafah. It was recorded in Sahih. Muslim that Abu Qatadah said, "The Messenger of Allah Sfe was asked about fasting on the day of 'Arafah, and he said, Lfdi ZJJ\ if jii JU sLJJ-U «I hope by Allah that it will be an expiation for the previous year and the coming year.^ These ten days include the day of An-Nahr (Sacrifice), which is the greatest day of Hajj, and it was recorded in a Hadith that it is the most virtuous day to Allah.*6' m Fath Al-Bdri 2:530. ' They are, respectively: saying La il&ha illallah; saying: AUahu Akbar ; and saying Al-Hamdu Lillah or their like. Ahmad 2:75. ' Al-Bukhari the Book of Al-'ldayn the chapter of the Virtue of (good) Deeds during the Days of Tashriq. |S| Muslim 2:819. 161 Ahmad 4:350.

560 Tafsir Ibt Kathir 4 over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them means, camels, cattle and sheep, as Allah explained in Surat Al-An'am: 4 {fj ieight pairs} [6:143] JjjSlil }fLflJ Lfi iThen eat thereof and feed tlireioith the poor having a hard time.} It was recorded that when the Messenger of Allah sg offered his sacrifice, he commanded that part of each animal should be taken and cooked, and he ate some of the meat and drank some of the broth. 4\$L \jk=*} iThen eat thereof} Hushaym narrated from Husayn, from Mujahid, "This is like the Ayat. 4)/>\lamA ^UL. y>\j} 4But when you finish the Ihram, you may hunt} [5:2] 4 ijLZ! iThen when the (Jumu'ah) Saldh (prayer) is ended, you may disperse through the land} [62: 10]."12 ' This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir in his Tafsir. 4the poor having a hard time.} 'Ikrimah said, "This means the one who is in desperate need whose poverty is apparent, and the poor person who is too proud to ask others for help."3' Mujahid said, "The one who does not stretch forth his hand Ahmad 1 :314. At-Tabari 18:611. At-Tabari 18:612.

567 Surah 22. Al-Haii (28-29) (Part-17 (to ask for help).) iThen let them complete their prescribed duties)> 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means ending Ihram by shaving one's head, putting on one's ordinary clothes, trimming one's nails and so on."121 This was also reported from him by 'Ata' and Mujahid. ' This was also the view of 'Ikrimah and Muhammad bin KaTb Al-Qurazi . iand perform their vows,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, this means any vows made about sacrificing a camel . iand circumambulate the 'Atiq House.} Mujahid said, "This means the Tawaf which is obligatoiy on the day of Sacrifice."6, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hamzah said, "Ibn 'Abbas said to me: 'Have you read in Surat Al-Hajj where Allah says: iand circumambulate the 'Atiq House.} The end of rituals is the Tawaf around the 'Atiq House. '"t71 I say, this is what the Messenger of Allah m did. When he came back from Mina on

the day of Sacrifice, he began with stoning the Jamrah,

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stoning it with seven pebbles, then he offered his sacrifice and shaved his head, then he departed and circumambulated the House." In the Two Sahths it was recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The people were commanded to end their visit to the Ka'bah by circumambulating the House, but menstruating 111 At-Tabari 18:612. [2) At-Tabari 18:613. At-Tabari 18:610. At-Tabari 18:610. At-Tabari 18:614. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur4 :643 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2490

562 Tafsir Ibn Kathir women are exempt from this. ^{3^— cv JL^ 4the 'Atiq House) the area from behind Al-Hijr, [2) because this was originally part of the Ka'bah built by Ibrahim, but the Quraysh excuded it from the House (when they had to rebuild it) because they were short of funds. The Messenger of Allah included it in his Tawaf and said that it is part of the House. He did not acknowledge the two Shami comers, because they were not built precisely upon the original foundations of Ibrahim. Qatadah narrated that Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on the Ayah, iand circumambulate the 'Atiq House.) "Because it is the first House established for mankind."13 ' This was also the view of 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.14 ' It was recorded that Ikrimah said, "It was called Al-Bayt Al-'Atiq because it survived (U'tiqah) from the flood at the time of Nuh." Khusayf said, "It was called Al-Bayt Al-'Atiq because it was never conquered by any tyrant."15' IS kzz *4#u ik&z & c 430. That and whoever honors the sacred things of Allah, then that is better for him with his Lord. The cattle are

lawful to you, except those (that will be) mentioned to you. So shun the Fath Al-B&ri 3 :684 Muslim 2 :963 ' The area near the Ka'bah that is enclosed by a low semi-circular wall. Al-Qurtubi 12:52. ' At-Tabari 18:615. ' There are a few narrations reported from the Salaf saying that the meaning of 'Atiq is "Ancient", and it is commonly translated that way. However, Ibn Kathlr's view is the common and most popularly reported view.

563 Surah 22. Al-Haii (30-31) (Part-17) Rijs of the idols, and shun false speech 431. Hunafd' Lillah, not associating partners unto Him; and whoever assigns partners to Allah, it is as if he had fallen from the sky, and the birds caught him in midair, or the wind had throion him to a far offplace.} The Reward for avoiding Sin Allah says: This is what We have commanded you to do in the rituals (of Hajj), and this is the great reward that the person who does that will gain.' iti' 4^- 0. cfji iwhoever honors the sacred things ofAllah,\$ means, whoever avoids disobeying Him and does not transgress that which is sacred, and regards committing sin as a very serious matter, i'±?j 4then that is betterfor him with his Lord.} means, he will attain much good and a great reward for doing that. Just as the one who does acts of obedience will earn a great reward, so too, the one who avoids sin will earn a great reward. Cattle are Lawful i^x u vt 0i\ 4The cattle are lawful to you, except those (that will be) mentioned to you.} means, "We have made permissible for you all the An'am (cattle etc.),' and Allah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sa'ibah or a WasUah or a Ham) 40,& c\$} iexcept those mentioned to you.} the prohibition of Al-Maytah}2] blood, the flesh of swine, and that on which Allah's Name has I 1 * See the Tafslof Surat Al-Ma'idah [5 :3) ^ See the Tafslof Surat Al-Ma'idah [5 :3]

not been mentioned while slaughtering (that which has been slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, or has been slaughtered for idols) and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal - unless you are able to slaughter it (before its death) - and that which is sacrificed (slaughtered) on An- NusubJ This was the view of Ibn Jarir, who recorded it from QatadahJ21 TheCommand to shun Shirkand Lying SjVr s.^4 4S0 shun the Rijs of the idols, and shun false speech> From this it is clear what Ar-Rijs means, i.e., avoid the abomination, which means idols. Shirk is mentioned in conjunction with false speech, as in the Ayah: y C ijSyu Sl> uili 4\$ay : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly, sins (of all kinds), unrighteous oppression, joinmg partners with Allah for which He has given no authority, and saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge" This includes bearing false witness. In the Two Sahths it was reported from Abu Bakrah that the Messenger of Allah sg said: fst r&l y'U «Shall I not tell you about the worst ofmajor sins?» We said, "Yes, O Messenger of Allah." He said: «Associating others with Allah, disobeying one's parents . ^ See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ma'idah [5 :3j 121 At-Tabari 18:618.

565 Surah 22. Al-Haii (30-31) (Part-17 He was reclining, then he sat up and said: Ni i jjjJ nand indeed giving false statements, and indeed bearing false witness...» and he kept on repeating it until we wished that he would stop."111 Imam Ahmad recorded that Khuraym bin Fatik Al-Asadi said, "The Messenger of Allah prayed As-Subh [Al-Fajr), and when he had finished, he stood up and said: 'f- jiiU \ oJai- B «Bearing false wittiess is on a par with the association of others ivith Allah . Then he recited this Ayah: * Sf' r'- 4)\ <k iSo shun the Rijs of the idols, and shun lying speech. Hunafa' Lillah, not associating partners unto Him;}^ ;ulL} ^Hunafa Lillah} means, sincerely submitting to Him Alone, shunning

falsehood and seeking the truth. Allah says: <k l&i& inot associating partners unto Him;} Then Allah gives a likeness of the idolator in his misguidance and being doomed and being far away from true guidance, and says: Ji- UjKj jit jjA J*j} iand whoever assigns partners to Allah, it is as if he had fallen from the sky,} meaning, Z&31} Path Al-Bari 10:419, Muslim 1:91. Ahmad 4:321

4the birds caught him in midair, 4or the wind had thrown him to afar offplace. means, remote and desolate, dangerous for anyone who lands there. Hence it says in the Hadith of Al-Bara': J "fi tjUJJl ^1 Ij-UjjJ Opl iSv">U ii'y IjJ jl» "illi* t>-p *>-jj JI *U-Ul uWheti the angels of death take the soul of the disbeliever in death, they take his soul up to the heaven, but the gates of heaven are not opened for him; on the contrary, his soul is thrown down from there, t'* 1 Then he recited this Ayah. The Hadith has already been quoted in our explanation of Surah Ibrahim ^ Allah gives another parable of the idolators in Surat Al-An'am, where He says: ipiS" ill UiJA -W Llict jje jjj lijjaj (jjLLi "if ll jll ^yj IpJjl *2 di>i \$ utf ji Ciil /i Sfc ^Vf 4 c&di i li «i' ^Srti/: "S/w// we invoke others besides Allah, that can do us neither good nor can harm us, and shall we turn back on our heels after Allah has guided us? - like one whom the Shayqtin have made to go astray in the land in confusion, his companions calling him to guidance (saying): 'Come to us.'" Say: "Verily, Allah's guidance is the only guidance."} [6:71] vp di *JyC & p!u «if ff) (\$£>) 4;," pJI cZf jl uU 432. Thus it is, and whosoever honors the Sha'd'ir of Allah, then it is truly from the Taqwa of the hearts.} 433. In them are benefits for you for an appointed term, and afterwards they are brought far sacrifice to the 'AtJq House.} Ahmad 4:287. See volume five, the Tafsir of Sdrah Ibrahim 14 :27.

Explanation of the Udhhiyyah and the Sha'a'irof Allah iattd whosoever honors the Sha'd'ir of Allah,) means, His commands. / ^** /•/ ^ » it is truly from the Taqwa of the hearts.) This also includes obeying His commands in the best way when it comes to offering sacrifices, as Al-Hakam said narrating from Miqsam, from Ibn 'Abbas: "Honoring them means choosing fat, healthy animals (for sacrifice)." Abu Umamah bin Sahl said: "We used to fatten the Udhhiyyah in Al-Madinah, and the Muslims used to fatten them." This was recorded by Al-Bukhari. (21 In Sunan Ibn Mdjah, it was recorded from Abu Rafi' that the Messenger of Allah jg sacrificed two castrated, fat, homed rams.131 Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded from Jabir: "The Messenger of Allah jg sacrificed two castrated, fat, homed rams."*41 It was jg said, "The Messenger of Allah jg commanded us to examine their eyes and ears, and not to sacrifice the Muqdbilah, the Mudabirah, the Sharqa, nor the Kharqa'." This was recorded by Ahmad and the Sunan compilers, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahih. As for the Muqdbilah, it is the one whose ear is cut at the front, Mudabirah is the one whose ear is cut at the back, the Shurqa is the one whose ear is split, as Ash-Shafi'i said. The Kharqa is the one whose ear is pierced with a hole. And Allah knows best. It was recorded that Al-Bara' said, "The Messenger of Allah sg said: 111 At-Tabari 18:621. 121 Fath Al-Bari 10:11. Ahmad 6:8 - he is the only one who reported this version as was stated by the author in Jami' Al-Masnid was-Sunan 14 :21 Abu Dawud 3:231, Ibn Majah 2 :1043. Ahmad 1:108, Abu Dawud 3:237, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:82, An-Nasal 7:217, Ibn Majah 2:1050.

568 Takir Ibtt Kathfr jyr^^ gj' "Four are not permitted for sacrifice: those that are obviously one-eyed, those that are obviously sick, those that are obviously lame and those that have broken bones, which no one would choose .» This was recorded by Ahmad and the Sunan compilers, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Sahth. The Benefits of the Sacrificial Camels icf ftP> iln them are benefits for you} meaning, in the

Budn (sacrificial camels) you find benefits such as their milk their wool and hair, and their use for riding. C2jp4lc^ft£» iln them are benefitsfor you for an appointed term,} Miqsam reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “Until you decide to offer them as a sacrifice.”*2 * It was recorded in the Two Sahihs from Anas that the Messenger of Allah jg saw a man driving his sacrificial camel and said, uRide it. » The man said, “It is a sacrificial camel.” He said, •Ride it, woe to you!* the second or third time.*3 According to a report recorded by Muslim from Jabir, the Messenger of Allah said: Ahmad 4:284, Abu Dawud 2802, At-Tirmidhi 1497, An-Nasal 7 :215, Ibn Majah 3144. > At-Tabari 18:623. * Fath Al-Bari 5 :450 , Muslim 2 :960

rn *> «i£Ji «Ride it gently accor- ding to your needs. gati^ / \ v " z ' s i>'< * X" W • r* Lfc-jbsj U Aj ^ A.iaL^Oi c.La>Jli l >> *- ' / »> ' '+s **' > '/> ^v ffS^j^Lxl*^ jQjQ_ ^AjsS s *' / ,/•/> / . * ' % . s : >rl . - . -." Jj-j ^4-JU,*1juS/ U.*--fJ^ 0}^-*^' jaU j,»v. ^LSi' 5\$ J 4jr^ oIJ' 4 UV iand afterwards they are brought for sacrifice to the ‘Atiq House.} meaning, they are eventually brought to the ‘Atiq House - which is the Ka'bah - as Allah says: iif&\ g, £ju\$> ian offering, brought to the Ka'bah [5:95] i%4 J uJCLi Csj1\)) iand detained the Hady, from reaching their place ofsacrifice} [48:25] ' &r>^ Ji ^jj C Jc ajii i\$jd idU Ll4 f.\ jk=dj} & (Uijl* Sj~j ii' fii lit jfjf Jfj Vjf} , -iii °jJj 'ijl if>,£>jk& f£ijj \le-j yL4 'ff-O L 134. And for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies, that they may mention the Name of Allah over the beast of cattle that He has given them for food. And your God is One God, so you must submit to Him Alone. And give glad tidings to the Mukhbitin . 135. Whose hearts are filled with fear ivhen Allah is mentioned, and the patient zoho bear whatever may befall them, and who Muslim 2 : 961

perform the Salah, and who spend out of what We have providedfor them.} Rites ofSacrifice have been prescribed for every Nation in the World Allah tells us that sacrifice and shedding blood in the Name of Allah has been prescribed for all nations. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4&^ 12K.&j^} iAnd for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies,} “Festivals.” ‘Ikrimah said, “Sacrifices.” 4^ i£; £\ iAnd for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies,} Zayd bin Aslam said, “This means Makkah; Allah did not appoint religious ceremonies anywhere else for any nation.”111 ithat they may mention the Name of Allah over the beast of cattle that He has given them forfood.} It was recorded in the Two Sahths that Anas said, “The Messenger of Allah sg brought two fat, homed rams; he said Bismillah and Allahu Akbar, then he put his foot on their necks.*21 4jA-* *4 iAnd your God is One God, so you must submit to Him Alone.} Your God is One, even though the Laws of the Prophets may vary and may abrogate one another. All of the Prophets called mankind to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. T“, 0 YJ '4 Y 2i;' iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :48 * Fath Al-Bari 10:25, Muslim 3 : 1556

577Surah 22. Al-Haii (34-35) <Part-U) revealed to him (saying) : None has the right to be zvorshipped but I, so worship Me.\$ [21:25]. Allah says: iso you must submit to Him Alone.> meaning, submit to His commands and obey Him in all sincerity. iAnd give glad tidings to the Mukhbitfn.i Mujahid said about Mukhbitin, “Those who find contentment in their faith.” m Ath- Thawri said, “Those who find contentment in their faith and who accept the decree of Allah and submit to Him.”121 It is better to interpret it by what comes next, which is: iWhose hearts are filled with fear when Allah is mentioned, meaning, their hearts fear Him. ^(*r^ C& dycjJbfr iand the patient who bear whatever may befall them>

meaning, of afflictions. ii&i ; iand who perform the Salah,) they fulfill the duties which Allah has enjoined upon them, the duty of performing the obligatory prayers. // •/* 'l' I* •" y iand zvho spend out ofivhat We have providedfor them .i the good provision which Allah has given them. They spend on their families and servants, and on the poor and needy; they treat people kindly while remaining within the limits set by Allah. This is in contrast to the hypocrites, who are the opposite of all this, as we have discussed in the Tafsir of Surah Bara'ah ; to Allah be praise and blessings. At-Tabari 18:628. TafsirAth-Thawri 213. See volume four, in the Tafsir of SdratAt-Tawbah 9 :67

% \$p &A&oiP&Z <\$£2ftspqp j0 %&j \±£j& j&£&x /// C~»rJ 436 . And the Budn, We have made them for you as among the symbols ofAllah, wherein you have much good. So mention the Name ofAllah over them when they are drawn up in lines (for sacrifice). Then, when they are down on their sides (after slaughter), eat thereof, andfeed the Qdni' and the Mu'tarr. Thus haveWe made them subject to you that you may be grateful .} TheCommand to slaughter the Budn (SacrificialCamel) Here Allah reminds His servants of the blessing which He has bestowed on His servants, by creating the Budn*** for them and making them one of His symbols. For He has decreed that they should be brought to His Sacred House; indeed, they are the best ofthatwhichmaybe offered as a sacrifice to Allah, as He says: 4#I ^% 531% £* Vj# Jgs& 4Violate not the sanctity of the Sha'd'ir of Allah, nor of the Sacred Month, nor of the animals brought for sacrifice, nor the garlanded people or animals, and others, nor the people coming to the Sacred House}[5:2\ iAnd the Budn, We have made them for you as among the symbols ofAllah,} Ibn Jurayj said: "Ata' commented on this Ayah, 'Cattle and camels.'"*2 ' A similar view was also reported from Ibn 'Umar, Said bin Al-Musayyib and Al-Hasan Al-Basri.*3 * Mujahid said: "Al-Budn means camels . ""*41 According to Muslim, Jabir bin 'Abdullah and others said, "The Messenger of Allah jg commanded us to share in offering the sacrifice, a Budn (camel) for seven people, and one cow for seven people."*5' 111 Its explanation follows 121 At-Tabari 18:630. Muslim 2 :882 * Ibn Abi Shaybah the unpublished section 367 * Muslim 2 :882

ixoherein you have much good.} means, reward in the Hereafter. 4So mention the Name ofAllah over them when they are drawn up in lines (for sacrifice).} It was reported from Al-Muttalib bin 'Abdullah bin Hantab that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "I prayed with the Messenger of Allah Sg on 'Id Al-Adha. When he finished, he brought a ram and slaughtered it, saying, "Bismillah, and Allahu Akbar. O Allah, this is on behalf ofme and anyone ofmy Ummah who has not offered a sacrifice . This was recorded by Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi. Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded from Yazid bin Abi Habib from Ibn 'Abbas that Jabir said, "The Messenger of Allah sg sacrificed two rams on the day of id, and when he lay them down to sacrifice them, he said: l 4J 4IX> i Ajj isV?) JI*-* j} Iff iiiii; in? 4 j «/ turn my face to the One Who created the heavens and the earth, being true and sincere in faith submitting myself to Him Alone, and I am not of the idolators. Verily, my prayer, my sacrifice, my living and my dying are for Allah, tire Lord of all that exists for, with no partner or associatefor Him . Thus am 1 commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims. O Allah, from You and to You, on behalf ofMuhammad and his Ummah . Then he said, 'BismiUdh' and 'Allahu Akbar' and slaughtered them."121 It was reported from 'Ali bin Al-Husayn from Abu Rafi' that Ahmad 3 :356 , Abu Dawud 3 :230 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5:113. ,2) Abu Dawud 3 :230,231. There are a number of narrations for this text which strengthen its authenticity

574 Tafsir Ibn Kathir when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ wanted to offer a sacrifice, he would buy two fat, homed, fine rams. When he had prayed and addressed the people, he would bring one of them to where he was standing in the prayer place, and would sacrifice it himself with a knife, then he would say: [^] - Lf- If- ' - «O Allah, this is on behalf of all of my Ummah, whoever bears witness of Tawhid of You and bears witness that I have conveyed.» Then he would bring the other ram and sacrifice it himself, and say, [^] - Lf- If- ' - «This is on behalf of Muhammad and the family of Muhammad.» He would give them to the poor and he and his family would eat from it as well. This was recorded by Ahmad and Ibn Majah. Al-A'mash narrated from Abu Zabiyan from Ibn 'Abbas, 4 ah' jw' [jy'&y iSo mention the Name of Allah over them when they are drawn up in lines (for sacrifice).} "When they are standing on three legs, with the left foreleg tied up. He says Bismillah and AUahu Akbar, La ilaha Ulalldh, AUahumma Minka wa Laka (In the Name of Allah and Allah is Most Great; there is no God but Allah. O Allah, from You and to You)." In the Two Sahih's it was recorded that Ibn 'Umar came to a man who had made his camel kneel down in order to sacrifice it. He said, "Make it stand up fettered, (this is) the Sunnah of Abu Al-Qasim (i.e. the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ)." Then, when they are down on their sides,} Ahmad 6:8 Ibn Majah 2:1043, 1044. [21 Al-Bukhari no. 1713.

575 Surah 22. Al-Haai (36) (Part-17) Ibn Abi Najih reported that Mujahid said, "This means, when it has fallen to the ground." * This was narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, and a similar view was narrated from Muqatil bin Hayyan. 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, ⁱThen, when they are down on their sides,} "Meaning, when they have died."121 This is what was meant by the comment of Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid, for it is not permitted to eat from the sacrifice when it has been slaughtered until it has died and its movements have ceased. It was reported in a Marfu' Hadith : *• *• ,* ' "Do not rush until you are sure that the animal is dead .»13' Ath-Thawri narrated in his Jami' that 'Umar bin Al-Khattab said that, and he supported it with the Hadith of Shaddad bin 'Aws in Sahih Muslim lijj i&iJl ^ JS ji-CiS 3>l OJ« k tAJiJl Iy~—>•U "Allah has prescribed proficiency in all things. If you kill, kill well; and if you slaughter, slaughter well. Let each one of you sharpen his blade and let him spare suffering to the animal he slaughters .»*4 It was recorded that Abu Waqid Al-Laythi said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Whatever is cut from an animal while it is still alive is Maytah (dead flesh). This was recorded by Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Sahih.*51 At-Jabari 18:635. At-Tabari 18:635. Al-Bayhaqi 9:278. * Muslim 3 : 1548 ' Ahmad 5 :518 , Abu Dawud 3 :277 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :55

eat thereof, and feed Qani' and the Mu'tarr...} This is a command which implies that this is permissible. Al- 'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, Qani is the one who is content with what he is given and he stays in his house, and the Mu'tarr is the one who comes to you and rubs shoulders with you so that you will give him some meat, but he does not ask for it." * This was also the view of Mujahid and Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi . [21 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Qdm' is the one who is too proud to ask, and Mu'tarr is the one who does ask."*31 This was also the view of Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakha'I and Mujahid, according to one report narrated from him . [41 And the opposite was also suggested. This Ayah has been quoted as evidence by those scholars who said that the sacrifice should be divided into three: a third for the one who offers the sacrifice to eat from, a third to be given as gifts to his friends, and a third to be given in charity to the poor, because Allah says: eat thereof, and feed the poor who does not ask, and the beggar who asks.} But there is no evidence in this Ayah for this view. According to a Sahih Hadith, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to the people: IjJ La 0-5

«/ used to forbid you to keep the meat of the sacrifice for more than three days, but now eat from it and keep it as you see fit.*™ According to another report: 111 At-Jabari 18:636. At-Tabari 18 :636 131 At-Tabari 18:363, 367. 141 At-Tabari 18:363, 367. An-Nasal 7 :234

«E(?f keep some and give some in charity .»|11 According to another report: 1jj.X-AiJ \ytjb\j «Eat some, feed others, and give some in charity .» As for the animal skins, it was recorded in Musnad Ahmad from Qatadah bin An-Nu'man in the Hadith about the sacrifice: j lio 1 k 1 j 1 «Eat and give in charity, and make use of the skins, but do not sell them .»|3 ' (Note) It was recorded that Al-Bara' bin 'Azib said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: ^'2* ^ ti j! ^ y* L^jli S^LaJI J-j c luxJ- Up «77ie first thing that we should do on this day ofours ('Id) is to pray, then we return and offer the sacrifice. Wlwever does that will have followed our Sunnah. Whoever slaughters his animal before the prayer, this is just meat which he has brought for his family, it is not a sacrifice at allJ This was recorded by (Al- Bukhari and Muslim). ,4) And in Sahih Muslim, it is mentioned that one is not to offer the sacrifice until the Imam (leader) has offered hisJ5! It is prescribed to offer the sacrifice on the day of Nahr and An-Nasal 7:170. Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :29 Ahmad 4:15. ^ Fath Al-Bari 2 :526 , Muslim 3 : 1553 Similar is mentioned in no . 5083 ofMuslim

578 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the following three days of Tashriq,11] because of the Hadith of Jubayr bin Mut'im who said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: «77ie days of Tashriq are all (for) sacrifice . » This was recorded by Ahmad and Ibn Hibban,121 iThus have We made them subject to you that you may be grateful.} means, for this reason. <*3 iThus have We made them subject to you} means, "We have subjugated them to you, i.e., We have made them submissive towards you, so that ifyou wish you can ride them, or if you wish you can milk them, or if you wish you can slaughter them,' as Allah says: iDo they not see that We have created for them of what Our Hands have created, the cattle, so that they are their owners.>[36:71] until He said: iWill they not then be grateful?} [36:73] And Allah says in this Ayah: 4'of& S0} iThus have We made them subject to you that you may be grateful.} ppL :p, 'KM && % VP \$X j} i37. It is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, Referring to the process of hanging the meat to dry in the sun. For more details , see volume one , the Tafsir of SaratAl-Baqarah 2 : 203 Ahmad 4:82.

579Surah 22. Al-Haii (37) (Part-17) but it is Taqwa from you that reaches Him. Thus have We made them subject to you that you may proclaim Allah's greatness for His guidance to you . And give glad tidings to the doers ofgood:} The Goal ofthe Udhiyyah (Sacrifice) according to Allah is the Sincerity and Taqwa ofHis Servant Allah says: this sacrifice is prescribed for you so that you will remember Him at the time of slaughter, for He is the Creator and Provider. Nothing of its flesh or blood reaches Him, for He has no need of anything other than Himself. During the time of Jahiliyyah, when they offered sacrifices to their gods, they would put some of the meat of their sacrifices on their idols, and sprinkle the blood over them. But Allah says: #x j} ilt is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah,} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Jurayj said, "The people of the Jahiliyyah used to put the meat of their sacrifices and sprinkle the blood on the House, and the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jfe said, "We have more right to do that." Then Allah revealed the words: i\$Xzp \$£ j£j is&% :c J} ilt is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, but it is Taqidvfrom you that reaches Him.} That is what He will accept and reward for, as mentioned in the Sahih, pji Ji 'M l&j ij&jif Ji V3 Jj v ai o!» «Allah

does not look to your appearance or your colors, but He looks to your hearts and deeds. n' 11 And in the Hadith ; «Indeed charity falls in the Hand of Ar-Rahman before it falls m Muslim 4 :1987.

in the hand of the one asking .x*11 ipcpAp} iThus have We made them subject to you} meaning, Tor this purposeWe have subjugated the Budn for you,' ipxh C iiT \fjpQ,} ithat you may proclaim Allah's greatness for His guidance to you .} means, that you may glorify Him for guiding you to His religion and His way which He loves and is pleased with, and has forbidden you to do all that He hates and rejects. ic\$—>Lj' iAnd give glad tidings to the doers ofgood.} means, 'give good news, O Muhammad, to those who do good,' i.e., whose deeds are good and who remain within the limits prescribed by Allah, who follow that which has been prescribed for them, who believe in the Messenger jg| and follow that which he has conveyed from his Lord. (Note) The Udhiyyah is SunnahMustahabbahP One animal is sufficient on behalf of all the members of one household. Ibn 'Umar said, "The Messenger of Allah jg continued to offer sacrifice for ten years." This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi.13 * Abu Ayyub said: "At the time of the Messenger of Allah jg, a man would sacrifice a sheep on behalf of himself and all the members of his household, and they would eat from it and feed others, until the people started Meaning a recommended practice. It must be noted here that these two Ay&t and most of the commentary related to them , is about the Hady or sacrificial animal for Hay. Much of the commentary generally applies to the sacrifice of Udhiyyah for the non-pilgrim as well. But the ruling of Mustahab, and the sacrifice after the prayer are among the statments that are not related to the Hady. For more details on the Hady see volume one , the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah (2:196). Al-Hiliyah 4 :81 . Similarwas recorded by Al-Bukhari no. 1410. I3 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :96

581Surah 22. Al-Haii (38) (Part-17) boasting (by sacrificing more than one] and things reached the stage that you see now." This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Sahih, and by Ibn MajahJ 'Abdullah bin Hisham used to sacrifice one sheep on behalf of his entire family; this was recorded by Al-BukhariJ2 ' Concerning how old the sacrificial animal should be, Muslim recorded from Jabir that the Messenger of Allah sg said: *jljail I 1* Ml t "/l «Do not sacrifice any but mature animals, and if that is not possible, then sacrifice a young sheep. 4 y'>J 435. Truly, Allah defends those who believe. Verily, Allah likes not any treacherous ingrate . Good News ofAllah's Defence for the Believers Here Allah tells us that He defends His servants who put their trust in Him and turn to Him in repentance; He protects them from the the worst of evil people and the plots of the sinners; He protects them, guards them and supports them, as He tells us elsewhere: 4/s not Allah sufficient for His servant?} [39:36] 4'£| p'jji }ly &r »* 'xA ''I A \$5*. iAnd whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him. Verily, Allah will accomplish his purpose. Indeed Allah has set a measurefor all things [65:3]. i Verily, Allah likes not any treacherous ingrate} means, He does not like any of His servants who bear these characteristics, i.e., treachery in covenants and promises Abu Dawud 5 :90 , Ibn Majah 2 :1051 121 Fath Al-Bdri 13:213. Muslim 3 :1555.

whereby a person does not do what he says, and ingratitude is to deny the blessings, whereby one does not acknowledge or appreciate them. Vi i*P jt ii' 'jlli pt juJJ i o4 < \$p vjij ii> LJj ijiji o>i Cf JSj> ' *. "Jj -*?—'J gj £*>-» -c.Si PP 6 op ii' Li <39. Permission (to fight) is given to those (believers) who are fought against, because they have been wronged; and surely, Allah is able to give them victory <40. Those who have been expelled from their homes unjustly only because they said: "Our Lord is Allah."

For had it not been that Allah checks one set of people by means of another, Saïodmi' , Biya' , Salawat, and Masjids, ivherein the Name of Allah is mentioned much, would surely have beat pulled down Verily, Allah will help those who help His (cause). Truly, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty, Permission to fight; this is the first Ayah of Jihad Al-'AwfI reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This was revealed about Muhammad sg and his Companions, when they were expelled from Makkah."111 Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others among the Salaf, such as Ibn 'Abbas, TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayan, Qatadah and others said, "This is the first Ayah which was revealed about Jihad."21 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the Prophet jg was driven out of Makkah, Abu Bakr said, They have their Prophet. Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return; surely they are doomed.' " Ibn 'Abbas said, "Then Allah revealed the words: < -J) . d®^ jij (Pi iPermission (to fight) is given to those (believers) fought against, because they have been wronged; and surely, Allah is At-Tabari 18:643. (21 At-Tabari 18:643, 644, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:87.

583 Surah 22. Al-Haii (39-40) (Part-27) able to give them victory.}" Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Then I knew that there would be fighting." Imam Ahmad added: "Ibn 'Abbas said, This was the first Ayah to be revealed concerning fighting." * This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and An- Nasal in the Book of Tafsir of their Sunans. * At-Tirmidhi said: "It is a Hasan Hadith." '<>' 3))} iattd surely, Allah is able to give them victory.} means, He is able to grant victory to His believing servants without any fighting taking place, but He wants His servants to strive their utmost in obeying Him, as He says: jUJ)' IjJLii v_ ty} 4 (&= *£ '•> fyQ J&j (*r< iii ilii J)> .llK lijlyl vvi-' 4So, zt?/ien yoM meef 1/iöse zuho disbelieve, strike necks till when you have killed and wounded many of them, then bind a bond firmly . Thereafter either for generosity, or ransom, until war lays doivn its burden. Thus, but if it had been Allah's will. He Himself could certainly have punished them. But (He lets you fight) in order to test some of you with others. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost. He will guide them and set right their state. And admit them to Paradise which He has made knmvn to them.} [47:4-6] (^! 4> fff- ii'j Cr* d iFight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them, and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of a believing people, arid remove the anger of their (believers') hearts. Allah accepts the repentance of whom He zvvills. Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} [9:14-15] *** Ahmad 1 :216. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:15, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :41 1

584 Tafsir Jbn Kathlir ft is*- ¥ 4And surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard and the patient, and We shall test yourfacts> (47:31). And there are many similar Ayat. Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, iand surely, Allah is able to give them (believers) victory "And this is what He did."11 Allah prescribed Jihad at an appropriate time, because when they were in Makkah, the idolators outnumbered them by more than ten to one. Were they to engage in fighting at that time, the results would have been disastrous. When the idolators went to extremes to persecute Muslims, to expel the Prophet jg and resolving to kill him; when they sent his Companions into exile here and there, so that some went to Ethiopia and others went to Al-Madinah; when they settled in Al-Madinah and the Messenger of Allah jg joined them there, and they gathered around him and lent him their support, and they had a place where Islam prevailed, and a stronghold to which they could retreat; then Allah prescribed Jihad against the enemy, and this was the first Ayah to be revealed for it. Allah said: 4>>- <*tiAii <Permission (to fight) is given to those fought against, because they have been wronged; and

surely, Allah is able to give them victory. Those who have been expelled from their homes unjustly Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said; "They were driven out of Makkah to Al-Madinah unjustly, i.e., Muhammad jg and his Companions."*2 ' At-Tabari 18:643. *21 At-Tabari 18:643.

585 Surah 22. Al-Haii (39-40) (Part-17) 4o/i/y because they said: "Our Lord is Allah."} means, they had not done anything to their people or committed any wrongs against them, apart from the fact that they believed in the Oneness of Allah and they worshipped Him Alone, with no partner or associate. But for the idolators, this was the worst of sins, as Allah says: iattd have driven out the Messenger and yourselves because you believe in Allah, your Lord!} (60:1). Then Allah says: iFor had it tiot been that Allah checks one set of people by weans of another,} meaning, were it not for the fact that He repels one people by means of another, and restrains the evil of people towards others by means of whatever circumstances He creates and decrees, the earth would have been corrupted and the strong would have destroyed the weak. iy^ iSaioami' surely have been pulled doivn means the small temples used by monks. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al-'Aliyah, 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and others.' Qatadah said, "This refers to the places of worship of the Sabians;" according to another report, he said, 'The Sawdmi' of the Zoroastrians." Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "These are houses along the roads." i&} iBiya' .} These are larger than the Sawami and accommodate more worshippers; the Christians also have these. This was the view of Abu Al-'Aliyah, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ibn Sakhr, " At-Tabari 18:647, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :59 , 60, Ar-Razi 3:36.

Muqatil bin Hayyan, Khusayf and others . Ibn Jubayr reported from Mujahid and others that this referred to the synagogues of the Jews which are known to them as Salut. And Allah knows best. iSalawat} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Salawat means churches."*21 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said that it referred to the synagogues of the Jews. Abu Al-'Aliyah and others said, "Salawat refers to the places of worship of the Sabians." Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid said, "Salawat refers to places of worship of the People of the Book and of the people of Islam along the roads."*31 Masjids belong to the Muslims. 4wherein the Name of Allah is mentioned much,} It was said that the pronoun refers to Masjids, because this is the closest of the words mentioned. Ad-Dahhak said, "In all of them the Name of Allah is often mentioned." Ibn Jarir said, "The correct view is that the monasteries of the monks, the churches of the Christians, the synagogues of the Jews and the Masjids of the Muslims, in which the Name of Allah is mentioned much, would have been destroyed - because this is the usual usage in Arabic. " *4 * Some of the scholars said, "This is a sequence listing the smallest to the greatest, because the Masjids are more frequented by more worshippers who have the correct intention and way." u4 a111 iVerily, Allah will help those who help His (cause).} This is like the Ayah : At-Tabari 18:648. At-Tabari 18:649. At-Tabari 18:650. At-Tabari 18:650.

pjl 'jjZ Jfjfy [cJjjJ i' o[!£•* Sr'jJ' 4 ; a '. 40 you who believe! If you help (in the cause of) Allah, He will help you, and make your foothold firm. But those who disbelieve, for them is destruction, and (Allah) will make their deeds vain.} [47:7-8] iTruly, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty .} Allah describes Himself as being All-Strong and All-Mighty. By His strength He created everything and measured it exactly according to its due measurements; by His might nothing can overpower Him or overwhelm Him, rather everything is humbled before Him and is in need of Him. Whoever is supported by the All-Strong, the All-Mighty, is indeed supported and helped, and his enemy will be overpowered. Allah says:

ft fa p\ QTdSztffr 4And, verily, Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers, that they verily, would be made triumphant, and that Our soldiers! They verily, would be the victors .} [37:171-173] iAlldh has decreed: “Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious.” Verily, Allah is All-Powerfid, All- Mighty.) [58:21] # \jg> oypx u^lj sjj&rt itfS0 402 0 441 . Tlwse who, ifWe give them power in the land, establish the Salah, enforce the Zakah, and they enjoin the good and forbid the evil. And with Allah rests the end of (all) matters .}

The Duties ofthe Muslims when They attain Power Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that TJthman bin ‘AfFan said, “The Ayah if !>*y ItrAj lp»j j {Those who, ifWe give them power in the land, (they) establish the Saldh, enforce the Zakah, and they enjoin the good and forbid the evil.} was revealed concerning us, for we had been expelled from our homes unjustly only because we said: ‘Our Lord is Allah.’ Then we were given power in the land, so we established regular prayer, paid the Zakah, enjoined what is good and forbade what is evil, and with Allah rests the end of (all) matters. This is about my companions and I .-”* 11 Abu Al- ‘Aliyah said, “They were the Companions of Muhammad 53.” As-Sabah bin Suwadah Al-Kindi said, “1 heard Umar bin ‘Abdul-'AzIz give a speech and say: 4 (4^2 j\t iM} iThose who, ifWe give them pozoer in the land. ...} Then he said, “This is not obligatory only for those who are in authority, it also applies to those who are governed by them. Shall I not tell you what you can expect from your governor, and what duties those who are ruled owe to him? Your rights over your governor are that he should check on you with regard to your duties towards Allah and restore the rights that you have over one another, and that he should guide you to the straight path as much as possible. Your duties towards him are that you should obey him without cheating and without resentment, and you should obey him both in secret and openly.” ‘Atiyah Al-‘Awfi said, “This Ayah is like the Ayah: Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2496 , 2497

589Surah 22. Al-Haii (42-46) (Part-17 iAllah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession to (the pre- sent rulers) in the land} [24 :55], iAnd ivith Allah rests

the end of (all) matters.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3754]

This is like the Ayah: },And the good end is for those who have Taqiva} [28 :83], Zayd bin Aslam said: i»'j} }And with Allah rests

the end of (all) matters.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3754–3762]

“And with Allah will be the reward for what they did.” J ©13^ rrv s s J. ^ ^^ ^ ^ ^ y-y^ f 'xS'isyd-** sf* .A. 3 y^ -A' ys** Ad'i'. ' ' OA^==>JU3.£)£.XXjijf) y > *'4~^rc'2itj f'J fiaJ c^4paj*\$5 « i / X;, X > * x > »V ..'•v « \ V' v-x»b ,»r.. i»j) cijj prS/j :A-> > • > >- / j>-o *>i" >. >•. j~j gy py r»+v C<-^==> oii jJf J.& «> ol6=> "•*! :t c'. - .j':. > .1 -ir •*- > - ->, >'•CmUw <S~J* '-d-JA- ijAri .\$. * :• ' * - < &v/ i_JU> OyA— ob»' j' Ojtijw s-i^» ujSoi j 4 ^*V Jjiii' 3 142. And if they deny you, so did deny before

them the people of Nuh, 'Ad and Thamiid.} 143. And the people of Ibrahim and the people of Lut,} m Ibn Abi Hatim 8:2498.

444. And the dwellers of Madyan; and denied zvas Musa. But I granted respite to the disbelievers for a while, then I seized them, and how (terrible) was My punishment!) 445. And many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, \$0 that it lie in ruins, and a deserted well and castle Mashld!) 446. Have they not traveled through the land, and have they hearts wherewith to understand and ears wherewith to hear? Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.) The Consequences for the Disbelievers Here Allah consoles His Prophet Muhammad jg for the disbelief of those among his people who opposed him. A, *. >*- iAnd if they deny you, so did deny before them the people of Nith) until His saying, iand denied was Musa.) means, despite all the clear signs and evidence that they brought. iBut I granted respite to the disbelievers for a while,) means, I delayed and postponed.' 4then I seized them, and how (terrible) was My punishment!) means, how great was My vengeance against them and My punishment of them!' In the Two Sahihs it is reported from Abu Mtisa that the Prophet \$g said: lil pjlku 2)1 j|8 'Allah lets the wrongdoer carry on until, when He seizes him. He will never let him go.* Then he recited: °J\ Si 53 46%) iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the

591Surah 22. Al-Haii (42-46) (Part-17 towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.) [11:102]' Then Allah says: iAnd many a township did We destroy} jfi} iwhile they were given wrongdoing,} meaning, they were rejecting their Messengers. iso that it lie in ruins,} Ad-Dahhak said, "[Leveled to] their roofs,"*2 * i.e., their houses and cities were destroyed. ifLhi f-p} iand (many) a deserted well} means, they draw no water from it, and no one comes to it, after it had been frequented often by crowds of people. iand a castle Mashfd!} 'Ikrimah said, 'This means whitened with plaster.'"*3 * Something similar was narrated from 'Ali bin Abi Talib, Mujahid, 'Ata', Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-Mulayh and Ad- Dahhak.*4 * Others said that it means high and impenetrable fortresses. All of these suggestions are close in meaning and do not contradict one another, for this sturdy construction and great height did not help their occupants or afford them any protection when the punishment of Allah came upon them, as He says: &&p&m &\$} i"Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in Buruj Mttshayyadah!") [4:78] m Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997 At-Tabari 18 :653 At-Tabari 18:654, 655. At-Tabari 18 :655, Al-Baghawi 3 :291

4u?jVf i. si—4 iHave they not traveled through the land,} means, have they not traveled in the physical sense and also used their minds to ponder? That is sufficient, as Ibn Abi Ad- Dunya said in his book At-Tafakkur wal-Ttib&r, "Some of the wise people said, 'Give life to your heart with lessons, illuminate it with thought, kill it with asceticism, strengthen it with certain faith, remind it of its mortality, make it aware of the calamities of this world, warn it of the disasters that life may bring, show it how things may suddenly change with the passing of days, tell it the stories of the people of the past, and remind it what happened to those who came before.' " Walk through their ruins, see what they did and what became of them, meaning, look at the punishments and divine wrath that struck the nations of the past who belied, ^ Zjs£ spj} iand have they hearts wherewith to understand and ears wherewith to hear?} meaning, let them learn a lesson from that. iVerily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} means, the blind person is not the one whose eyes cannot see,

but rather the one who has no insight. Even if the physical eyes are sound, they still cannot learn the lesson. i k-iiV iICj Xi ly> fJ&j ijibe ^ / » // / * . SS « / < V • -' * • . . *• 447. And they ask you to hasten on the torment! And Allah fails not His promise. And verily a day with your Lord is as a thousand years of what you reckon.} 448. And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then I seized it (ivith punishment) . And to Me is the (final) return (ofall).}

593Surah 22. Al-Haij (42-46) (Part-17 The Disbelievers Demand for the Punishment Allah tells His Prophet sg : iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment!) meaning, these disbelievers who disbelieve in Allah and His Book and His Messenger and the Last Day. This is like the Ayat j»J' j* 'x* '^!Li x ' - Si*V 7" > > " -i ' iAnd (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} (8:32) i ff j3 ilEj u Sk% iThey say: "Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittana (our punishment) before the Day ofReckoning!"} [38:16]. iZj %\ Jig Jj} iAnd Allah fails not His promise.} means, His promise to bring about the Hour and wreak vengeance upon His enemies, and to honor His close friends. (/ *->' X Xv' 's' ' *9' * - <*JUD tioj J^E; \aj> iAnd verily a day with your Lord is as a thousand years of what you reckon.} means, He does not hasten, for what is counted as a thousand years with His creation is as one day with Him, and He knows that He is able to exact revenge and that He will not miss a thing, even if He delays and waits and postpones. Hence He then says: i IS' J!j fciil >J illlli (1 cfX^ J) yfE=-j} iAnd many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrotigdomg. Then I seized it (with punishment) . And to Me is the (final) return (ofall).} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the

Messenger of Allah jg said: tThe poor among the Muslims will enter Paradise half a day before the rich - five hundred yearsJ This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal from the Hadith of Ath-Thawri from Muhammad bin 'Amr. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih."* 11 Abu Dawud recorded at the end of Book of Al-Malahim in his Sunan from Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas that the Prophet jg said: «/ hope that it will not be too much for my Ummah if Allah delays them for halfa day .» It was said to Sa'd, "What does half a day mean?" He said, "Five hundred years. £ ti U\ -i - •if' * f' ?; - tj qu>I> ullu Say: "O mankind! I am (sent) to you only as a plain Warner."} 450. So those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them is forgiveness and Rizq Karim.} 451 . But those who strive against Our Aydt to frustrate than, they will be dwellers of the Hellfire.} The Recompense ofthe Righteous and the Unrighteous Allah said to His Prophet jg, when the disbelievers asked him to hasten on the punishment for them: 4Say: "O mankind! I am (salt) to you only as a plain wamer."} TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:21, An-Nasal in Al-Kubru 6 :412. * Abu Dawud 4:517.

595Surah 22. Al-Haii (49-51) (Part-17 meaning, 'Allah has sent me to you to warn you ahead of the terrible punishment, but I have nothing to do with your reckoning. Your case rests with Allah: if He wills, He will hasten on the punishment for you; and if He wills, He will delay it for you. If He wills he will accept the repentance of those who repent to Him; and if He wills, He will send astray those who are decreed to be doomed. He is the One Who does whatsoever He wills and wants and chooses. iThere is none to put back His judgement and He is swift at reckoning. [13:41) 4/ am (sent) to you only as a plain Warner. So those who believe and do righteous good deeds,) means, whose hearts believe and whose actions confirm their faith. if-S VS*& ifor them is forgiveness and Rizq Karim.) means, forgiveness for their previous bad deeds, and a great reward in return for a few good deeds. Muhammad

bin KaTj Al-Qurazi said, “When you hear Allah’s saying: lujj) iRizq Karim) this means Paradise.” 4u^ iJjfp) iBut those who strive against Our Ayat tofrustrate them,) Mujahid said, “To discourage people from following the Prophet .’12] jhjg was ajgQ the view of ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr, “to discourage.”*31 Ibn ‘Abbas said, “To frustrate them means to Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :63 At-Jabari 18:662. *31 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :64

596 Tafsir Ibn Kathir resist the believers stubbornly.” 4they will be dwellers of the Hellfire.) This refers to the agonizingly hot Fire with its severe punish- ment, may Allah save us from it. Allah says: o* i. ' f "" ^ Oj* ll'-AC- ^£>*1 4Ji' J-J— •=> L*J > > ^ / > •> ^ OJVi 4Tfwse who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them I've will add tor- ment to the torment be- cause they used to spread corruption> [16:88] rr* t&mm oAS[j ^>L1k£..£Jg e ajil , 'X'» " , *i . ^ ?,\S' » -> , ' -*.'***** *^'^-> l*_9| v-fl-3jl3 < > *>: oi> : . c t " 1i!->i" .If >>> , ' *> " ,3>- *J^Xj^ ; ~ > .ZKjV v_JAc \$ ALJ14JJukc.Lll I ii .lA—* ' &*j 'H %^ X} J>Aj <>j j* , bL-j* C> ^ C J*»3 .lA? 'i~>f "Si* ^^~a'4 ^~5 j-AalAl' JiL £ ii' - ^Ab (Ue»»» (*r_>s 4 ^ vv ^0 « a ji/& ^yjr 0^ <3] !£•* <4s' iU1 Si* C>b | h4» 452. Never did We send a Messenger or a Prophet before you but when he did recite (the revelation or narrated or spoke), Shaytan threw (some falsehood) in his recitation (of the revelation). But Yansakh Allah that which Shaytan throws in. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :64

597 Surah 22. Al-Haii (52-54) (Part-17) Then Allah establishes His revelations. And Allah is All-Knoier, All-Wise 453. That He (Allah) may make what is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease and whose hearts are hardened. And certainly, the wrongdoers are in an opposition far-off (from the truth).} 454. And that those who have been given knowledge may know that it (this Qur'an) is the truth from your Lord, so that they may believe therein, and their hearts may submit to it with humility. And verily, Allah is the Guide of those who believe, to the straight path.}

How the Shaytanthrowsome Falsehood into theWords

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3762–3763]

ofthe Messengers, and how Allah abolished that At this point many of the scholars of Tafsir mentioned the story of the Gharaniq and how many of those who had migrated to Ethiopia came back when they thought that the idolators of the Quraysh had become Muslims, but these reports all come through Mursat chains of narration and 1 do not think that any of them may be regarded as Sahih. And Allah knows best. Al-Bukhari said, “Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4in his recitation (of the revelation).} “When he spoke, the Shaytan threw (some falsehood) into his speech, but Allah abolished that which the Shaytan threw in.”121 4Then Allah establishes His revelations.} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, iwhen he did recite (the revelation), Shaytan threw (some falsehood) in it} Mursal : A chain of narration that stops before the Companion 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :292

“When he spoke, the Shaytan threw (some falsehood) into his speech.” * Mujahid said: iwhen he did recite^ “When he spoke.”*2 ’ It was said that it refers to his recitation, whereas, ip ibut they trust upon Amani} means they speak but they do not write.*3 ’ Al-Baghawi and the majority of the scholars of Tafsir said: ip ihe did recite} “Reciting the Book of Allah.” iShaytan threw (somefalsehood) in it} “In his recitation.”*4 Ad-Dahhak said: ip iwhen he did recite} “When he recited.”*5 Ibn Jarir said, “This

comment is more akin to interpretation.”*6 i'pp J,£%££} iBut Yansakh Allah that which Shaytdn throws in.}

The meaning of the word Naskh in Arabic is to remove or lift

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3763–3766]

away. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means, Allah cancels out that which the Shaytdn throws in.”*7 At-Tabari 18:667. * At-Tabari 18:667. * See volume one , the Tafsirof SuratAl-Baqarah (2 :78) ' Al-Baghawi 3 :293 At-Tabari 18:668. ' At-Tabari 18 :668 At-Tabari 18:668.

599Surah 22. Al-Haii (52-54) (Part-17) 4And Allah is Atl-Knower means, He knows all matters and events that will happen, and nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. 4All-Wise.\$ means, in His decree, creation and command, He has perfect wisdom and absolute proof, hence He says: 4That He (Allah) may make wliat is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease> meaning, doubt, Shirk, disbelief and hypocrisy. Ibn Jurayj said: 4those in whose hearts is a disease “The hypocrites, and 4and whose hearts are hardened means the idolators.” 4And certainly, the wrongdoers are in an opposition far-off. means, far away in misguidance, resistance and stubbornness, i.e., far from the truth and the correct way. 4.^, %\ 4And that those who have been given knowledge may know that it is the truth from your Lord, so that they may believe therein means, ‘so that those who have been given beneficial knowledge with which they may differentiate between truth and falsehood, those who believe in Allah and His Messenger, may know that what We have revealed to you is the truth from your Lord, Who has revealed it by His knowledge and under His protection, and He will guard it from being mixed with anything else.’ Indeed, it is the Wise Book which, m At-Tabari 18:669.

‘ S J) .*iuAji*- ^ Vj ajjJ ^ ^ iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise (Allah).} [41:42] 4so that they may believe therein,} means, that they may believe that it is true and act upon it. iand their hearts may submit to it with humility.} means, that their hearts may humble themselves and accept it. i>>? off} iAnd verily, Allah is the Guide of tlwse who believe, to tlie straight path.} means, in this world and in the Hereafter. In this world, He guides them to the truth and helps them to follow it and to resist and avoid falsehood; in the Hereafter, He will guide them to the straight path which leads to the degrees of Paradise, and He will save them from the painful torment and the dismal levels of Hell. "• * „> .. ^ -if .*-y s •ac.lui f+*y . i li/j CLty' jj} tj iyi-fj offfcy p 4 jv^=w: Aii - ‘41 «l* ' „ s-Of- 455. And those who disbelieved, will not cease to be in doubt about it until the Hour comes suddenly upon them, or there comes to them the torment ofYawm Aqhn.} i56. The sovereignty on that Day will be that ofAllah. He will judge between them. So those 10/10 believed and did righteous good deeds will be in Gardens ofDelight.} 457. And those who disbelieved and denied Our Aydt, for them will be a humiliating torment (in Hell).}

The Disbelievers will remain in Doubt and Confusion Allah tells us that the disbelievers will remain in doubt concerning this Qur’an. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir. 111 it* iaS &} iuntil the Hour conies suddenly upon them,} Mujahid said: “By surprise.”121 Qatadah said: isuddenly} means, the command of Allah will catch the people unaware. Allah never seizes a people except when they are intoxicated with pride, enjoying a life of luxury, and they think that the

punishment will never come upon them, but Allah does not punish anyone except the evildoers. } ior there comes to them the torment ofYaivm 'Aqim .} Mujahid said, “Ubay bin Kah said: ‘Yawm 'Aqim means the day of Badr.’” Ikrimah and Mujahid said: “Yawm ‘Aqim means

the Day of Resurrection, following which there will be no

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3766–3772]

night.”¹³¹ This was also the view of Ad-Dahhak and Al-Hasan Al-Basri. * Allah says: £-?y. —MUJif iThe sovereignty on that Day will be that of Allah. He will judge between them.} This is like the Ayat iThe Only Owner of the Day ofRecompense} [1:4] iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty), belonging to the Most Gracious (Allah), and it will be a hard Dayfor the disbelievers.} [25:26] At-Tabari 18:670. At-Tabari 11 :360. 131 Al-Baghawi 3 :295. 141 Al-Baghawi 3 :295

603Surah 22. Al-Haii (58-60) (Part-17) wronged, Allah will surely help him. Verily, Allah indeed is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving The GreatReward forThoseWho migrate in theCause of Allah Allah tells us that those who migrate for the sake of Allah, seeking to earn His pleasure and that which is with Him, leaving behind their homelands, families and friends, leaving their countries for the sake of Allah and His Messenger to support His religion, then they are killed, i.e., in Jihad, or they die, i.e., they pass away without being involved in fighting, they will have earned an immense reward. As Allah says: 4\$& r 5 ‘Ay-j) Si &f) 4And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reivard is then surely incumbent upon Allah) {4:100} LjJj% isurely, Allah will provide a good provision for them.) means, He will reward them from His bounty and provision Paradise with that which will bring them joy. >vr JSJ# in 4And verily, it is Allah Who indeed is the Best of those who make provision. Truly, He will make them enter an entrance with which they shall be well-pleased,) This means Paradise, as Allah says elsewhere: JL * , ‘j^ K > y * i/»// » •". y iThen, if he be of those brought near (to Allah), rest and provision, and a Garden ofDelights .) [56:88-89], Allah tells us that He will grant him rest and provision and a Garden of Delights, as He tells us here: isurely, Allah will provide a good provision for them.) Then He says:

iTruly, He ivill make than enter an entrance with which they shall be loell-pleased, and verily, Allah indeed is All-Knowing, meaning, He is All-Knowing about those who migrate and strive in Jihad for His sake and who deserve that (reward). iMost Forbearing, means, He forgives and overlooks their sins, and He accepts as expiation for their sins, their migration (Hijrah) and their putting their trust in Him. Concerning those who are killed for the sake of Allah, whether they are Muhajirs (migrants) or otherwise, they are alive with their Lord and are being provided for, as Allah says: rtfS S iThink not of those as dead ivho are killed in the way ofAllah. Nay, tthey are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision [3:169]. There are many Hadttths on this topic, as stated previously. With regard to those who die for the sake of Allah, whether they are emigrants or not. This Ayah and the Sahih Hadiths guarantee that they will be well provided for and that Allah will show them kindness. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Shurahbll bin As-Simt said: “We spent a long time besieging a stronghold in the land of the Romans. Salman Al-Farisi, may Allah be pleased with him, passed by me and said, 1 heard the Messenger of Allah sg say: in in^j ‘ ^ oU ‘•j • (*~4 jj 4%J5 \$\$\$%£} f jjj ^ 1 Hi \$ «Whoever dies guarding the borders of Islam, Allah will give him a reward like that reward (of martyr) and will provide for him and keep

him safe from trials. Recite, if you wish: Those who emigrated in the cause of Allah and after that were killed or died, surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them. And

605 Surah 22. Al-Haai (58-60) (Part-17) verily, it is Allah Who indeed is the Best of those who make provision. Truly, He will make them enter an entrance with which they shall be well-pleased, and verily, Allah indeed is All-Knowing, Most Forbearing}! 4^ He also recorded that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Jahdam Al- Khawlani was with Fadal bin 'Ubayd when they accompanied with two funerals, at (an island of) sea one of whom had been struck by a catapult, and the other had passed away. Fadal bin 'Ubayd sat by the grave of the man who had passed away and someone said to him, "Are you neglecting the martyr and not sitting by his grave?" He said, "I would not mind which of these two graves Allah would resurrect me from, for Allah says: Those who emigrated in the cause of Allah and after that were killed or died, surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them And he recited these two Ayat, then said, "What should I seek, O you servant, if I were to enter an entrance to His pleasure, and be provided good provisions? By Allah, I would not mind which of these two graves Allah would resurrect me from." 121 C& O'J 4 That is so. And whoever has retaliated with the like of that which he was made to suffer.... Muqatil bin Hayan and Ibn Jurayj mentioned that this was revealed about a skirmish in which the Companions encountered some of the idolators. The Muslims urged them not to fight during the Sacred Months, but the idolators insisted on fighting and initiated the aggression. So the Muslims fought them and Allah granted them victory. Verily, Allah indeed is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.} Ibn Abi Hatim 8:2503. At-Tabari 9 :182

607 Siirah 22. Al-Haai (61-62) (Part-17) and You make the day to enter into the night, You bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living. And You give wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit.} [3:26-27]

The meaning of “merging” the night into the day and the day

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3772–3792]

into the night is that the one encroaches upon the other, and vice versa. Sometimes the night is long and the day is short, as in winter, and sometimes the day is long and the night is short, as in summer. And verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} He hears what His servants say, and He sees them, nothing about them or their movement is hidden from Him whatsoever. When Allah tells us that He is controlling the affairs of all that exists, and that He judges, and there is none to reverse His judgement. He says: / “J/N -* /-./v 4iP-' _y> *»' it i That is because Allah - He is the Truth,} meaning, the true God, besides Whom no one deserves worship. He is the Possessor of the greatest sovereignty; whatever He wills happens and whatever He does not will does not happen. Everything is in need of Him and submits to Him. Ot £ &s} i and what they invoke besides Him, it is false.} meaning, the idols and false gods. Everything that is worshipped instead of Him - may He be exalted - is false, because it can neither bring benefit nor cause harm. <£&} i And verily, Allah - He is the Most High, the Most Great.} This is like the Ayat. i and He is the Most High, the Most Great} [42:4]

the Most Great, the Most High} [13:9]. Everything is subject to His might and power; there is no God except Him and no Lord besides Him, because He is the Almighty and there is none mightier than He,

the Most High and there is none higher than He, the Most Great and there is none greater than He. Exalted, sanctified, and glorified be He far above all that the evildoers say. cJuLi ^Ai o' dL~*-IJ <4<j oj*>V' Jw o-*w ^ ^ y ZjM jfj ,%lL-»y Jjj'lj) iif ill] a*j% V] Jc '> ^63 . See i/oh not that Allah sends down water from the sky, and then the earth becomes green? Verily, Allah is the Most Kind and Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things .} 464. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth. And verily, Allah - He is Rich, Worthy of all praise.} 465. See you not that Allah has subjected to you all that is on the earth, and the ships tlrnt sail through the sea by His command? He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave. Verily, Allah is for mankind, full of kindness, Most Merciful.} 466. It is He, Who gave you life, and then will cause you to die, and iwill again give you life. Verily, man is indeed Kafurun.} Signs of the Power of Allah This is a further sign of His might and power; that he sends the winds to drive the clouds which deliver rain to the barren land where nothing grows, land which is dry, dusty and desiccated. izz&Z S3 If>} ibut when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells} [22:5].

iattd that the earth becomes green?\$ This indicates the sequence of events and how everything follows on according to its nature. This is like the Ayah: \ i^JUL LiUvi iikll liL. iThen We made the Nutfah liJ into a clot , then We made the clot into a little lump offlesh} [23:14]. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that between each stage there are forty days.121 Allah's saying, iand then the earth becomes green} means, it becomes green after being dry and lifeless. It was reported from some of the people of Al-Hijaz that the land turns green after rainfall. And Allah knows best. . "P iVerihj, Allah is the Most Kind and Courteous, Well- Acquainted with all things.} He knows what seeds are in the various regions of the earth, no matter how small they are. Nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. Each of those seeds receives its share of water and begins to grow, as Luqman said: j J j j' iA- 4 oi ju-i eju i"0 my son! If it be equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well- Aware.} [31:16] And Allah says: See the explanation of Surat Al-Hajj (22 :4) Fath Al-Bari 6 :350 , Muslim 4 :2036

ships sail gently with their passengers and carry them wherever they want to go for trading and other purposes from one land to another, so that they bring goods from here to there, or vice versa, whatever people want or need. 4He ivithholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave.} If He willed, He could give the sky permission to fall on the earth, and whoever is in it would be killed, but by His kindness, mercy and power, He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth, except by His leave. He says: HtS ccdit -it iVerily, Allah is for mankind, full of kindness, Most Merciful .} meaning, even though they do wrong. As Allah says elsewhere: iBut verily, your Lord is fidl of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is severe in punishment} [13:6]. ilt is He, Who gave you life, and then will cause you to die, and iwill again give you life. Verily, man is indeed Kafurun.} This is like the Aycit Cl! r -4 r* by! pi :C-»j 4&t> JtlS} 4How can you disbelieve in Allah? Seeing that you were dead and He gave you life. Then He will give you death, then again iwill bring you to life and then unto Him you will return.} [2:28], 4c vt; If jy) dl &A y 'r 'S^rA. 4*^ 4Say : "Allah gives you life, then causes you to die, then He will assemble you on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt."} [45:26],

673 Surah 22. Al-Hajj (67-69) (Part-17) invite them to your Lord. Verily, you indeed are on the straight guidance.} 468. And if they argue with you, say: "Allah knows best of what you do."} 469. "Allah will judge between you on the Day of Resurrection about that wherein you used to differ."} Every Nation has its Religious Ceremonies Allah tells us that He has made Mansak for every nation. Ibn Jarir said, "This means that there are Mansak for every Prophet's nation." He said, "The origin of the word Mansik in Arabic means the place to which a person returns repeatedly, for good or evil purposes. So the Manasik (rites) of Hajj are so called because the people return to them and adhere to them." If the phrase "For every nation We have ordained religious ceremonies" means that every Prophet's nation has its religious ceremonies as ordained by Allah, then the phrase "So let them (the pagans) not dispute with you on the matter" refers to the idolators. If the phrase "For every nation We have ordained religious ceremonies" means that it is the matter of Qadar (divine decree), as in the Ayah, 4 For each nation there is a direction to which they face} [2:148] Allah says here: i which they Ndsikuh meaning, which they must act upon. The pronoun here refers back to those who have these religious ceremonies and ways, i.e., they do this by the will and decree of Allah, so do not let their dispute with you over that divert you from following the truth. Allah says: / ^ •> /> /<" < <P «%> ibut invite them to your Lord. Verily, you indeed are on the straight guidance.} in At-Tabari 18:678, 679.

614 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i.e., a clear and straight path which will lead you to the desired end. This is like the Ayah: til} p -'Tl'j' cJ/ jju 4I0 ^ikJuoi 4And let them not turn you away from the Ayat of Allah after they have been sent down to you: and invite to your Lord£ [28:87] 4And if they argue with you, say: "Allah knows best of what you do."} This is like the Ayah: 14 tfj jil IL i3 £j; 4^ 4 ja ijj.iT o<j> 4. t' 4And if they belie you, say: "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!"} [10:41] ic|£JS C %} iAllah knows best of what you do.} This is a stern warning and definite threat, as in the Ayah: cji! '^r- *#{ ojiaui fjA 4He knows best of what you say among yourselves concerning it! Sufficient is He as a witness between me and i/oa/^[46:8]. fVllah says here: iAllah will judge between you on the Day of Resurrection about that wherein you used to differ.} This is like the Ayah: Ji iill J/j tlj Jij Vj Cj'j' K *--=> ^ 4S0 »»/o Hu's then invite, and stand firm as you are commanded, and follow not their desires but say: "I believe in whatsoever Allah has sent down of the Book."} [42:15]

<ui1 tiU'j u'j. 4 o}. 4 l* «il ^>1 |vuu 4:f 470. K/rozy you no/ that Allah knows all that is in the heaven and on the earth? Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easy for Allah.} Allah tells us how perfect is His knowledge of His creation, and that He encompasses all that is in the heavens and on earth. Not even the weight of a speck of dust, or less than that or greater escapes His knowledge in the heavens or in the earth. He knows all things even before they happen, and He has written that in His Book, Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz, as was reported in Sahih Muslim from 'Abdullah bin 'Arar, who said, "The Messenger of Allah said: j jSl lj y_StL» jjj 4))1 <jl "jUJl 4-1^p jISj "Allah issued His decrees concerning the measurement and due proportion of the creatures fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth, and His Throne was over the waterV In the Sunan, it was reported from a group of the Companions that the Messenger of Allah said: £ li : Jli ?4J-S\ U j : Jti tjij bpJLdJl <<1)1 t aiiOJl ^ y> Uj jUill Sj** ' 8The first thing that Allah created was the Pen. He said to it, "Write!" It said, "What should I write?" He said, "Write what will happen," so the Pen wrote everything that will happen

until the Day of Resurrection Allah says: 4 Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easy for Allah.} Muslim 4 :2044 ' Abu Dawud 5 :76 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :232

02 (IAjirMl j^S -*< l*j .4. jijj J L rllf 'J£*LT\ \fj£ c<fM jyi.j 4 J^s &£ (Ui >; -i' Iaj*j jdi> 'SO'j jj j» «#ju»# far i?l . And they worship besides Allah others for which He has set down no authority, and of which they have no knowledge; and for the wrongdoers there is no helper.> 472. And when Our clear Ayat are recited to them, you will notice a denial on the faces of the disbelievers! They are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our Ayat to them. Say : “Shall I tell you of something worse than that? The Fire which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved, and worst indeed is that destination!”} The Idolators’ worship of others besides Allah and Their vehement rejection of the Ayat of Allah Allah tells us that the idolators, in their ignorance and disbelief, worship besides Allah others which He has sent down no authority for, i.e., no proof or evidence for such behavior. This is like the Ayah: *-> -*£ H* ** ^ V cyj? 4 And whoever calls upon, besides Allah, any other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers will not be successful.} [23:117] So Allah says here: 4ps •*< kill. .* j> J 4 for which He has sent down no authority, and of which they have no knowledge;} meaning, they have no knowledge in the subject that they fabricate lies about; it is only something which was handed down to them from their fathers and ancestors, with no evidence or proof, and its origins lie in that which the Shaytan beautified for them and made attractive to them. Allah warned them:

617 Surah 22. Al-Hajj (71-72) (Part-17 and for the wrongdoers there is no helper.) meaning, no one to help them against Allah when He sends His punishment and torment upon them. Then Allah says: i And when Our clear Ayat are recited to them,} means, when the Ayat of the Qur’an and clear evidence and proof for Tawhid of Allah are mentioned to them, and they are told that there is no god besides Allah and that the Messengers spoke the truth, &&& i They are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our Ayat to them.} then they nearly attack and do harm to those who bring proof to them from the Qur’an, and cause them harm using their tongues and hands. i Say} O Muhammad to these people, i f j j £ < i l' j G l t i Shall I tell you of something worse than that? The Fire which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved,} The fire and wrath and torment of Allah are far worse than that with which you are trying to scare the believing close friends of Allah in this world. The punishment in the Hereafter for these deeds of yours is worse than that what you claim you want to do to the believers. 4-W 1 ' J and worst indeed is that destination!} how terrible is the Fire as a final destination and abode! i Evil indeed it is as an abode and as a place to rest in.} [25:66]

J& 9>\ uj <3# Si j£^ JLUJi i\$£> 44M&^U ^ I\$£ oU \$1 l^Uf JJ f££ 4\S —£jtj3j «i* oj 3»- <J' Ltjjdj & 'vr'/.f U.lj 473. O mankind! A parable has been made, so listen to it: Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are the seeker and the sought.} 474. They have not regarded Allah with His rightful esteem. Verily, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty.} The insignificance of the Idols and the foolishness of their Worshipers Here Allah points out the insignificance of the idols and the foolishness of those who worship them. 43*; j.u i\$£> 40 mankind! A parable has been made,} meaning, a parable of that which is worshipped by those who are ignorant of Allah and who join others as partners with Him. (41 4 so listen to it) pay attention

and understand. •J A\ 4Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose.} Even if all the idols and false gods whom you worship were to come together to create a single fly, they would not be able to do that. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah recorded the Marfu report: Ji->- jl Z\j'i j\ ij'i Ji; [ULc] ji». pilit t"Who does more wrong than one who tries to create something like My creation? Let them create an ant or a fly or a seed like

My creation!"*™ This was also recorded by the authors of the Two Sahihs via 'Umarah from Abu Zur'ah from Abu Hurayrah, who said that

the Prophet said: ^ jliy 4-*^ Cr-i iAllah says: "Who does more wrong than one who tries to create (something) like My creation? Let them create an ant, let them create a grain of barley Then Allah says: 4And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly .} They are unable to create a single fly and, moreover, they are unable to resist it or take revenge against it if it were to take anything from the good and perfumed thing on which it lands. If they wanted to recover that, they would not be able to, even though the fly is the weakest and most insignificant of Allah's creatures. Allah says: 4So weak are the seeker and the sought.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "The seeker is the idol and the sought is the fly."31 This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and it is what is apparent from the context. As-Suddi and others said, "The seeker is the worshipper, and the sought is the idol." 41 Then Allah says: 4They have not regarded Allah with His rightful esteem .} meaning, they have not recognized the might and power of Allah when they worship alongside Him those who cannot Ahmad 2:391. Fath Al-Bari 13:537, Muslim 3 :1671 At-Jabari 18:685. Al-Baghawi 3 :298 , from Ad-Dahhak

621 Surah 22. Al-Haii (75-76) (Part-17) 475. Allah chooses Messengers from angels and from men. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.> 476. He blows what is before them, and what is behind them. And to Allah return all matters.4 Allah chooses Messengers from the Angels and Messengers from Mankind Allah tells us that He chooses Messengers from His angels as He wills by His law and decree, and He chooses Messengers from mankind to convey His Message. 4^^ iVerily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer. means, He hears all that His servants say, and He sees them and knows who among them is deserving of that, as He says: 4a3^ ^ 4Allah blows best with whom to place His Message [6:124] 4He blows what is before them, and what is behind them. And to Allah return all matters.> He knows what will happen to His Messengers and the Message He sent them with, for none of their affairs are hidden from Him. He says: 4'1 fijlj £ jS- <J^ 4"The All-Knower of the Chayb (Unseen), and He reveals to none His Ghayb."^[72:26] until His saying; iand He keeps count of all things.} [72:28] So He, may He be glorified, is guarding them, and is Witness to what is said about them. He is protecting them and supporting them. a 'Mj xiS a J oii oj 4 z

40 Messenger! Proclaim which has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind4 [5:67]. A3 IjLksaf \yS\, I'g'jr'.Aa o; uy!' ^ Cj ji- jJif ^ '-*r4-i <j£3 '3* tj j l j; 3ii _y» auL iy'-j JJAil' u-llif jc '.Cyi |yj3j 4 xa , 4>jT jUj 477 . O 1/OK who believe! Boiv down, and prostrate yourselves, and worship your Lord and do good that you may be successful. 478. And strive hard in Allah's cause as you ought to strive. He has chosen you, and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship: it is the religion of your father Ibrahim. He has named you Muslims both before and in this (Qur'an), that the Messenger may be a witness over you and you be witnesses over mankind! So, perform the Saldh, give the Zakah and hold fast to Allah.

He is your Mawla, what an Excellent Mawla and what an Excellent Helper/> The Command to worship Allah and engage in Jihad It was reported from Tjubah bin 'Amir that the Prophet jg said: £>JI C-Lai a Surat Al-Hajj has been blessed with two Sajdahs, so whoever does two prostrate them should not read them .»[li j*-\$ 4 4And strive hard in Allah's cause as you ought to strive. means, with your wealth and your tongues and your bodies. This is like the Ayah: I 1 * Al-Hakim 1 :221. The addition, "so whoever does not prostrate at them should not read them" is considered unauthentic. The source for the Hadith was mentioned and noted earlier. See Ayah no. 18.

4Have Taqwa of Allah as is His due.} [3:102] 4He has chosen you,} means, 'O Ummah [of Islam], Allah has selected you and chosen you over all other nations, and has favored you and blessed you and honored you with the noblest of Messengers and the noblest of Laws.' 4g/*- Si J-***- iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship} He has not given you more than you can bear and He has not obliged you to do anything that will cause you difficulty except that He has created for you a way out. So the Salah, which is the most important pillar of Islam after the two testimonies of faith, is obligatory, four Rak'ahs when one is settled, which are shortened to two Rak'ah when one is traveling. According to some Imams, only one Rak'ah is obligatory at times of fear, as was recorded in the HadithJ ' A person may pray while walking or riding, facing the Qiblah or otherwise. When praying optional prayers while traveling, one may face the Qiblah or not. A person is not obliged to stand during the prayer if he is sick; the sick person may pray sitting down, and if he is not able to do that then he may pray lying on his side. And there are other exemptions and dispensations which may apply to the obligatory prayers and other duties. So the Prophet said: "/ have been sent with the easy HanTfi 121 way . And he said to Mu'adh and Abu Musa, when he sent them as governors to Yemen: IjiL* Yj Abu Dawud 2:38. Meaning monothiest. See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf (7 :30) Ahmad 5 :266

"Give good news and do not repel them. Make things easy for the people and do not make the things difficult for them .»m And there are many similar Hadiths. Ibn 'Abbas said concerning the Ayah, i; 4 Cj} iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship}, "This means difficulty."*2 ' tit is the religion of your father Ibrahim .} Ibn Jarir said, "This refers back to the Ayah, igs- bt 4 iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship meaning, any difficulty." On the contrary, He has made it easy for you, like the religion of your father Ibrahim. He said, "It may be that it means: adhere to the religion of your father Ibrahim."131 I say: This interpretation of the Ayah is like the Ayah: Ci !>» JI n iSay: "Trtdy, my Lord has guided me to a straight path , a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, a Hanif } [6:161] ef) (5? Cr, iHe has named you Muslims both before and in this (Qur'an),} Imam 'Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak said, narrating from Ibn Jurayj, from 'Ata', from Ibn 'Abbas: concerning Allah's saying, 4& « iHe has named you Muslims before 111 Fath Al-Bari 7 :657 At-Tabari 18:689. At-Tabari 18:691. 141 See earlier note

625Surah 22. Al-Haii (77-78) (Part-17) "This refers to Allah, may He be glorified." ' This was also the view of Mujahid, 'Ata', Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Qatadah.'2 ' Mujahid said, "Allah named you Muslims before, in the previous Books and in Adh-Dhikr,' iand in this} means, the Qur'an."4 This was also the view of others, because Allah says: 4He has chosen you, and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship} Then He urged them to follow the Message which His Messenger jg brought, by reminding them that this was the religion of their father Ibrahim. Then He mentioned His blessings to this Ummah, whereby He mentioned them and praised them long ago in the Books of the

Prophets which were recited to the rabbis and monks. Allah says: }He has named you Muslims both before} meaning, before the Qur'an, <0 4and in this.} Under the explanation of this Ayah, An-Nasal recorded from Al-Harith Al-Ash'ari from the Messenger of Allah Sfe, who said: •Whoever adopts the call of Jahiliyyah, iwill be one of those who will craiul on their knees in Hell. A man said, "O Messenger of Allah, even if he fasts and performs Saldh?" He said, 111 At-Tabari 18:691 At-Tabari 18:691,692. ' See volume six, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya' (2 1 : 105) ' Al-Qurtubi 12:101.

626 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir SUp Lfj l <b I ijfi-ju I^Pili k^U*?j jjj jv-*^ «<il "Yes, eoen i//ie /asfs and performs Salah. So adopt the call of Allah whereby He called you Muslims and believers and servants of Allah. »(1 i'JS js ;T£ £& 1I4 46itff the Messenger may be a ivitness over you and you be witnesses over mankind!} means, 'thus We have made you a just and fair nation, the best of nations, and all other nations will testify to your justice. On the Day of Resurrection you will be, io0&&& 4witnesses over mankind},' because on that Day all the nations will acknowledge its leadership and its precedence over all others. Therefore, on the Day of Resurrection the testimony of the members of this community will be accepted as proof that the Messengers conveyed the Message of their Lord to them, and the Messenger will testify that he conveyed the Message to .them. IjCj ;j&i &ji} 4So perform tire Salah, give Zakah} means, respond to this great blessing with gratitude by fulfilling your duties towards Allah, doing that which He has enjoined upon you and avoiding that which He had forbidden. Among the most important duties are establishing regular prayer and giving Zakah. Zakah is a form of beneficence towards Allah's creatures, whereby He has enjoined upon the rich to give a little of their wealth to the poor each year, to help the weak and needy. We have already mentioned its explanation in the Ayah of Zakah in Syrat At- Tawbah (9:5). IjwCcl'})} 4and hold fast to Allah.} means, seek the help and support of I 1 ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd no . 1:8866.

627Surah 22. Al-Haii (77-78) (Part-17)) Allah and put your trust in Him, and get strength from Hiih. iHe is your Maiula,} meaning, He is your Protector and your Helper, He is the One Who will cause you to prevail against your enemies. iwhat an Excellent Mawla and zohat an Excellent Helper!} He is the best Mawla and the best Helper against your enemies.

Surah 23: Al-Muminun

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 6, 7

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Which was Revealed inMakkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3793–3798]

P *- rtt % J50&W Pcjpj0ojldl^Ld2Jjli iil!'iQuijPcP 45^i3i^05s#fi^liitj;c3>c iSK0^2ji^f^30^ /n the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. «y* 'tp^AP'^ (U bpj ;£!&*-> (*r^-" j> •> ^ .1^^ s* > •> :u r* £#!> ^ ^ ijfc 'fy ^ c££ c i^ <-*T "i V ^ ^ *>?><• &*) V** > (*ri »jJji)Jlj liil'j »pj * "'*' • '/Ip ' .If' »*J+<y v <%>!> • .".' 'S' -If' -- ' > ' frp~° Cr js cyJ'j , jjc-ii £ Jtfj PpJPk oyj-t -<fj& S.ojjfr 4>' 't* r“ 41 . Successful indeed are the believers.) 42. Those who with their Salah are Khashi'un.) 43. And those who him awayfrom Al-Laghw.) 44. And those who pay the Zakah.) 45. And those who guard their private parts.)

629Stirah 23. Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) i6. Exceptfrom their wives or their right hand possessions, for then, they arefreefrom blame.} 47. But whoever seeks beyond that, then those are the transgressors.} 48. Those who are faithfully true to their Amdnat and to their covenants are Rd'tin .} 49. And those who strictly guard their Salawdt.} 410. These are indeed the heirs.} 411. Wlw shall inherit Firdaws. They shall dwell therein forever.} The Success is for the believers whose qualities are described here ?& 4Successful indeed are the believers} means, they have attained victory and are blessed, for they have succeeded. These are the believers who have the following characteristics: 4Those who with their Salah are Khashi'un.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: “4Khashi'tin means those with fear and with tranquillity.”* 11 This was also narrated from Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri.*2 * It was reported from 'Ali bin Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him, that Khushu' means the Khushu' of the heart.'3 * This was also the view of Ibrahim An-Nakha'i.*4 * Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, “Their Khushu ‘ was in their hearts.” So they lowered their gaze and were humble towards others. Khushu' in prayer is only attained by the one who has emptied his heart totally, who does not pay attention to anything else At-Tabari 19:9. 2| At-Tabari 19:8, 9. ' At-Tabari 19:9. * At-Tabari 19 :9

631Surah 23. Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) the soul from Shirk and filth, as in the Ayah v O' k- i O' jJ? ilndeed he succeeds who purifies himself (Zakkdhd). And indeed he fails who corrupts himself.} [91:9-10] It could be that both meanings are intended, purification of the soul and of one's wealth, because that is part of the purification of the soul, and the true believer is one who pays attention to both matters. And Allah knows best. O* jf- £ j' ipOj* if- J'V'Ojki-* 4 . j/jU' ^ ditj 0^ iAnd those who guard their private parts. Except from their wives and their right hand possessions, for then, they are free from blame. But whoever seeks beyond that, then those are the transgressors.} means, those who protect their private parts from unlawful actions and do not do that which Allah has forbidden; fornication and homosexuality, and do not approach anyone except the wives whom Allah has made

permissible for them or their right hand possessions from the captives. One who seeks what Allah has made permissible for him is not to be blamed and there is no sin on him. Allah says: ik >U) ji. ithey are free from blame. But whoever seeks beyond that meaning, other than a wife or slave girl, then those are the transgressors.} meaning , aggressors. A.oy-'j iThose who are faithfully true to their Amdndt and to their covenants} When they are entrusted with something, they do not betray that trust, but they fulfill it, and when they make a promise or make a pledge, they are true to their word. This is not like the hypocrites about whom the Messenger of Allah jg said:

lijj < 1 jJ-j lilj n^iJS lij : jilLJl Z~\ «The signs of the hypocrite are three: when he speaks he lies, when he makes a promise he breaks it, and when he is entrusted with something he betrays that trust. a /> . s // > " .f/ 4And those who strictly guard their Salaivat means, they persistently offer their prayers at their appointed times, as Ibn Mas'ud said: "I asked the Messenger of Allah \$\$\$, 'O Messenger of Allah, which deed is most beloved to Allah?' He said, «Prayer at the appointed time.* I said, Then what?' He said, aKindness to one's parents .# I said. Then what?' He said, «Jihqd in the way ofAllah.* It was recorded in theTwo SahihsJ2' Qatadah said: "At the fixed times, with the proper bowing and prostration." Allah begins and ends this list of praiseworthy qualities with Salah, which is indicative of its virtue, as the Prophet said: «Adhere to righteousness, you will never be able encompass it all. Know that the best of your deeds is Salah. None will preserve his Wuddu' except the believer. Having described them with these praiseworthy characteristics and righteous deeds, Allah then says: Fath Al-Bari 10:522. Fath Al-Bari 10:414, Muslim 1 :89. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :89 141 Ibn MSjah 2:101

Silrah 23. Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) 633 JL0}> iThese are indeed the heirs. Wlw shall inherit Firdaios. They shall dwell therein forever.} It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah gj said: «C-BJ t I ' * s ll 1 »» ' *- * ? * « .j-y '5-wvn aIfyou ask Allah for Paradise, then ask him for Al-Firdaws, for it is the highest part of Paradise, in the middle of Paradise, and from it spring the rivers of Paradise, and above it is the (Mighty) Throne of the Most Merciful .# |I) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Messenger of Allah said: ^ . - j # - » •* t oU jli vj0l Jyjj 3'j~* - o)! 'i .oy/f jU JIji <!>Jl jii jtlll jiji 'There is not one among you who does not have two homes, a home in Paradise and a home in Hell. If he dies and enters Hell, the people of Paradise will inherit his home, and this is

what Allah said: iThese are indeed the heirs.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3798–3824]

Ibn Jurayj narrated from Layth from Mujahid: iThese are indeed the heirs.} "The believers will inherit the homes of the disbelievers because they were created to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. So when these believers did what was enjoined on them of worship, and the disbelievers neglected to do that which they were commanded to do and for which they had been created, the believers gained the share that they would have been given if they had obeyed their Lord. Indeed, they will be given more than that as well." This is what was reported in Sahth Muslim from Abu Burdah, from his father, 111 Fath Al-Bari 13:415. Ibn Majah 2:1453.

from the Prophet ﷺ who said: *ill iJlOjJl Jlili _'yX Or?4— iri* ‘Some of the Muslims will come on the Day of Resurrection with sins like mountains, but Allah will forgive them and put (their burden of sin) on the /eras and Christians According to another version: the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *lii : Jlij iir^ j\ 4^ jkl 'j>\ £ aoiil oil liu* *When the Day of Resurrection comes, Allah *zwill* appoint for every Muslim a Jeio or Christian, and it will be said, "This is your ransom from the Fire."o “Umar bin ‘Abd Al-‘AzIz asked Abu Burdah to swear by Allah besides Whom there is no other God, three times, that his father told him that from the Prophet ﷺ, and he swore that oath.¹² ' I say: this Ayah is like Allah’s saying: 4 Ar , & lijL* l/i Cjjj iSuch is the Paradise which We shall give as an inheritance to those of Our servants who have had Tacpoa> [19:63] ££ Uj liylliyl Qfx iUJ ait}} 4This is the Paradise which you have been made to inherit because of your deeds which you used to do. [43:72] ^ <4 jdi » Cj* L .VU- Jljly 3 Hi dig UiiF t^KS uu uuS 122 Sil&i A > t|:oyy'MM i3i ? £3# 453 >C&£& 412. And indeed We created man out of an extract of Tin. 413. Thereafter We made him a Nutfah in a safe lodging. ^ Muslim 4 :2120 •2| Muslim 4:2119.

414. Then We made the Nut/ah into a clot, then We made the dot into a little lump of flesh, then We made out of that little lump of flesh bones, then We clothed the bones with flesh, and then We brought it forth as another creation. So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} 415. After that, surely you will die.} 416. Then (again), surely you will be resurrected on the Day of Resurrection .} The Sign of Allah in the progressive creation of Man from Clay then from Nutfah and thereafter Allah tells us how He initially created man from an extract of Tin. This was Adam, peace be upon him, whom Allah created from sounding clay of altered black smooth mud. Ibn Jarir said, “Adam was called Tin because he was created from it.”^ Qatadah said, “Adam was created from 7Tn.”¹²¹ This is the more apparent meaning and is closer to the context, for Adam, upon him be peace, was created from a sticky Tin, which is a sounding clay of altered black smooth mud, and that is created from dust, as Allah says: ,- Til JJ y Crt (3 4And among His signs is this that He created you (Adam) from dust, and then - behold you are human beings scattered!} [30:20] Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Musa that the Prophet ﷺ said: *jJi ^1* yj JL>J If J?J 1J si—iJlj iJlj \Zj fJA |Ol (ji>* jU* “Allah created Adam from a handfid which He picked up from throughout the earth, so the sons of Adam came forth accordingly, red and white and black and in between, evil and good and in between »|31 ^ At-Tabari 19:15. At-Tabari 19:14. Ahmad 4:400.

Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi recorded something similar. At-Tirmidhi said, “It is Sahih Hasan.” 4Thereafter We made him a Nutfah.} Here the pronoun refers back to humankind, as in another Ayah: <y, at Jili J-** > t at iand He began the creation of man from clay. Then He made his offspring from semen of despised water.} [32:7,8] meaning, weak, as He says: *j!y j a; jbaX& f\}* iDid We not create you from a despised water? Then We placed it in a place of safety.} [77:20-21] meaning the womb, which is prepared and readily equipped for that, 4For a known period. So We did measure; and We are the Best to measure [77:22-23] meaning, for a known period of time, until it is established and moves from one stage to the next. Allah says here, 4<Ulc iilJl LiU. 4Then We made the Nutfah into a clot,} meaning, “then We made the Nutfah, which is the water gushing forth that comes from the loins of man, i.e., his back, and the ribs of woman, i.e., the bones of her chest, between the clavicle and the breast. Then it becomes a red clot, like an elongated clot.’ ‘Ikrimah said, “This is blood.” iSL}l Lii^j} 4then We made

the dot into a little lump offlesh,} which is like a piece of flesh with no shape or features. 4£&e Siiiff &&>} m Abu Dawud 5 :67, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :290

4then We made out of that little lump offlesh bones, meaning, *We gave it shape, with a head, two arms and two legs, with its bones, nerves and veins.' \jy&} 4then We clothed the bones with flesh,} meaning, *We gave it something to cover it and strengthen it.' 4%: &&% iand then We brought it forth as another creation .} means, 'then We breathed the soul into it, and it moved and became a new creature, one that could hear, see, understand and move.' £3a ij3} 4So Blessed is Allah, the Best ofcreators.} iand then We brought itforth as another creation.} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "We change it from one stage to another until it emerges as an infant, then it grows up through the stages of being a child, adolescent, youth, mature man, old man and senile man." Imam Ahmad recorded in his Musnad that 'Abdullah - Ibn Mas'ud - said, "The Messenger of Allah jg, the Truthful One, told us: Jij Oj&i 4 oilaj U jl*j ^ jJ jj5l lUlJj JU j p jj ill V jJ I ji tJ-*— j\ ijy*. ja Jij 4 j t <I>-j ijijj :otljd j. ... » i V[I4I->j <-< jj£j U !>& * jiiij jiti~ judj^» 4 1fed jiiii jiti a^ jitiUo ij 4^ji vi Jir «The creation of anyone of you is gathered for forty days in his mother's stomach as a Nutfah, then he becomes a clot for a similar period of time, then he becomes a little lump offlesh for a similar length of time. Then the angel is sent to him and he m At-Tabari 19:18.

breathes the soul into it, and four things are decreed: his provision, his life-span, his deeds, and whether he will be wretched or blessed. By the One besides Whoin there is no other god, one of you may do the deeds of the people of Paradise until there is no more than a forearm's length betxoeeen him and it, then the decree will overtake him ajtd he will do the deeds of the people of Hell and thus enter Hell. And a man may do the deeds of the people of Hell until there is no more than a forearm's length between him and it, then the decree will overtake him and he will do finally the deeds of the people of Paradise and thus enter Paradise.^ (1 This was recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.121 iSo Blessed is Allah, the Best ofcreators.} means, when Allah mentions His ability and subtlety in creating this Nutfah and taking it from stage to stage until it takes the shape of a perfectly formed human being, He says, 4U0£\$ &&} 4So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} iAfter that, surely you will die.} means, after first being created from nothing, you will eventually die. £A% iThen (again), surely you will be resurrected on the Day of Resurrection.} means, you will be created anew. stiUtf iif Z} iand then Allah will bring forth the creation of the Hereafter} (29:20] means, the Day of Return, when the souls will be restored to their bodies and all of creation will be brought to account. Everyone will be rewarded or punished according to his deeds [1 > Ahmad 1 :382. 121 Fath At-Bari 6 :4 18 , Muslim 4 :2036

639Siirah 23. Al-Mn'minun (17) (Part-18) - if they are good then he will be rewarded, and if they are bad then he will be punished. \$3£ Cj £1 imZ& i17 . And indeed We have created above you seven Tara'iq, and We are never unaware of the creation .} His Sign in the creation ofthe Heavens After mentioning the creation of man, Allah then mentions the creation of the seven heavens. Allah often mentions the creation of the heavens and earth alongside the creation of man, as He says elsewhere: yU- vc -sf=='' Jfjijj iThe creation of die heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind} [40:57]. A similar Ayah appears at the beginning of Surat As-Sajdah, which the Messenger of Allah jg used to recite on Friday mornings. At the beginning it mentions the creation of the heavens and earth, then it says how man was created from semen from clay, and it also discusses the

resurrection and rewards and punishments, and other matters. iseven Tara'iq.} Mujahid said, "This means the seven heavens." 1 11 This is like the Ayat iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him}[17:44] iSee you not hoto Allah has created the seven heavens one above another?} [71:15] Or* 4/y ofe j&h VV ySi" jt- cSjj' i:f;& id a si% *js> Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :94 .

640 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 411 is Allah Who has created seven heavens and of tlte earth the like thereof. His command descends between them (heavens and earth), that you may know that Allah has power over all things, and that Allah surrounds all things in (His) bmvledge} [65:12] Similarly, Allah says here: tf Qil £ ft c; 4And indeed We have created above you seven Tara'iq, and We are never unaware of the creation.} meaning, Allah knows what goes into the earth and what comes out of it, what comes down from heaven and what goes up into it. He is with you wherever you are, and Allah sees what you do. No heaven is hidden from Him by another and no earth is hidden from Him by another. There is no mountain but He knows its features, and no sea but He knows what is in its depths. He knows the numbers ofwhat is in the mountains, the hills, the sands, the seas, the landscapes and the trees. .u nr mmI , ? . - " > " , uLialiQ*}{iju *rr;v \xj\ yo/£- I: .-jU 4 1,7?^ cffi oiUt 4 *4»- Vj Cri !**——> Cj} 4And not a leaffalls, but He kttows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} [6:59]

>3 bliili w'ojjXiii _jl»i j* bjj ufy'^ <4 j-ii 5 jy> bt tr^J •* ojs l; l ti1j i&gj Jrif oi i4 tLj 4 ojyj 'vjO^Si ^jy o-&j3C oxj »Ul- 4:%Z\$^ <^> j*j i^cj ^ IjjiT £££ j3j 428. And We sent dozen from the sky water in measure, and We gave it lodging in the earth, and verily, We are able to take it azvay 429. Then We brought forth for you therewith gardens of date palms and grapes, wherein is much fruit for you, and ivhereof you eat.} 420. And a tree that springs forth from Tur Sinai, tlrt grows oil, and relish for the eaters .} 422. And verily, in the cattle there is indeed a lesson for you. We give you to drink of that zohich is in their bellies . And there are, in them, numerous benefitsfor you, and of them you eat.} 422. And on them, and on ships you are carried.} Allah's Signs and Blessings in the Rain, Vegetation, Trees and Cattle Allah mentions His innumerable blessings to His servants, whereby He sends down rain in due measure, meaning, according to what is needed, not so much that it damages the lands and buildings, and not so little to be insufficient for crops and fruits, but whatever is needed for irrigation, drinking and other benefits. If there is a land that needs a lot of water for its irrigation but its fertile soil would be carried away if rain fell on it, then Allah sends water to it from another land, as in the case of Egypt, which is said to be a barren land. Allah sends the water of the Nile to it, which brings red soil from Ethiopia when it rains there. The water brings the red soil which is used to irrigate the land of Egypt, and whatever of it is deposited is used for agriculture, because the land of Egypt is infertile, and most of it is sand. Glory be to the Subtle One, the All-Knowing, the Most Merciful, the Forgiving. 4 <£j&}

}and We gave it lodging in the earth,} means, "when the water comes down from the clouds, We cause it to settle in the earth, and We cause the earth to absorb it and the seeds etc. in the earth to be nourished by it." -ii & ^\)} iand verily, We are able to take it away.} means, 'if We wanted to cause it not to rain, We could do so; if We wanted to divert it towards the wilderness and wastelands, We could do so; if We wanted to make it salty so that you could not benefit from it for drinking or irrigation, We could do so; if We wanted to cause it not to be absorbed by the earth, but to remain on the surface, We could do so;

if We wanted to make it go deep underground where you would not be able to reach it and you could not benefit from it, We could do so.' But by His grace and mercy, He causes sweet, fresh water to fall on you from the clouds, then it settles in the earth and forms springs and rivers, and you use it to irrigate your crops and fruits, and you drink it and give it to your livestock and cattle, and you bathe and purify yourselves with it. To Him is due the praise and thanks. iThen We brought forth for you thereuntil gardens of date palms and grapes,} means, "from that which We send down from the sky, We bring forth for you gardens and orchards which look beautiful.' Jr^y oi} 4of date palms and grapes,} These were the kinds of gardens that were known to the people of the Hijaz, but there is no difference between a thing and its counterpart. The people of each region have fruits which are the blessing of Allah given to them, and for which they cannot properly thank Allah enough. <lg 41%£} iioherein is much fruit for you,} means, of all fruits. As Allah says elsewhere:

foP' jL*, g)' * > ja LZ 4With it [the rain] He causes to groio for you the crops, the olives, the date palms, the grapes, and even/ kind of fruit> [16 : 11], iand whereof you eat.} This implies that you look at its beauty, wait for it to ripen, then eat from it. 4And a tree that springs forthfrom Tur Sinai,} means the olive tree. Tur means a mountain. Some of the scholars said, "It is called Tur if there are trees on it, and if it is bare it is called Jabal, not Tur. And Allah knows best. Mount Sinai is the same as Tur Sinin, and it is the mountain on which Allah spoke to Musa bin 'Imran, peace be upon him, and in the surrounding mountains there are olive trees. ithat groivs oil,} Some scholars think it [linguistically] means that it brings forth oil. Others say it [linguistically] means "comes forth with oil." Allah said, iand relish} meaning a condiment, according to QatadahJ' ifor the eaters.} means, it contains a beneficial oil and condiment. 'Abd bin Humayd recorded in his Musnad and Tafsir from 'Umar that the Messenger of Allah said: \ * £• «£rtf (olive) oil as a condiment and apply it as oil, for it comes from a blessed tree . IM Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :95 .

It was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah. 1 ' 1 Allah's saying; <& 4 iL; ju3 fei 4p10 jfy<& iAttd verily, in the cattle there is indeed a lesson for you. We give you to drink of that which is in their bellies. And there are, in them, numerous benefits for you, and of them you eat. And on them and on ships you are carriedK Here Allah mentions the benefits He has given to His servants in cattle, for they drink their milk which comes out from between dung and blood, they eat their meat and clothe themselves with their wool and hair, they ride on their backs and carry heavy burdens on them to far away lands, as Allah says: .jjuVi «-:»v » till p&duS j^0 i±t iAnd they carry your loads to a land that you could not reach except with great trouble to yourselves. Truly, your Lord is full of kindness, Most Mercifiit (16:7) 4Do they not see that We have created for them of what Our Hands have created, the cattle, so that they are their owners. And We have subdued them unto them so that some of them they have for riding and some they eat. And in them there are benefits for them, and drink. Will they not then be grateful [36:71-73] y? nyy JtP t* fy&>. Jh» -Au* j], C-y diSjl aS% ol ij. iK C U& SEP '4 35\$£ OiC\$^ 155c -4 j#£ Al-Muntakhab by 'Abd bin Humayd 13, At-Tirmidhi 1815, Ibn MSjah 3319.

4 >8? 423. And indeed We sent Nidi to his people, and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqwa?"} 424. But the chiefs of his people who disbelieved said: "He is no more than a human being like you, he seeks to make himself superior to you. Had Allah willed, He surely could have salt down angels. Never did we hear such a thing among

our fathers of old." \$ 425. "He is only a man in whom is madness, so wait for him a while." 4 The Story of Nuh, Peace be upon Him; and his people Allah tells us about Nuh, peace be upon him, whom He sent him to his people to warn them of the severe punishment of Allah and His severe vengeance on those who associated partners with Him, defied His commands and disbelieved His Messengers: <13 IS 4 and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqwa?" } Meaning, "Do you not fear Allah when you associate others in worship with Him?" The chiefs or leaders of his people said: 4 ^ =& Jin; j ^ S C } 4 He is no more than a human being like you, he seeks to make himself superior to you. } meaning, he is putting himself above you and trying to make himself great by claiming to be a Prophet, but he is a human being like you, so how can he receive revelation when you do not?' 4 c & p j / f % }

i Had Allah willed, He surely could have sent down angels. meaning, 'if Allah had wanted to send a Prophet, He would have sent an angel from Him, not a human being. We have never heard of such a thing - i.e., sending a man to our forefathers' - their predecessors in times past. 4 He is only a man in whom is madness, } means, "he is crazy in his claim that Allah has sent him and chosen him from among you to receive revelation." so wait for him a while. } means, Wait until he dies, put up with him until you are rid of him.' o4 XI juK jwj J ^ => 'ti —LU— jtjj VjJ \$ w <4 \$ && Sii a ^ x; ^ \$ Jr dj Kjc* Xa* ^ yj J > j iS ^ jii ^ jf 426. He said: "O my Lord! Help me because they deny me." } 427. So, We revealed to him: "Construct the ship under Our Eyes and under Our revelation. Then, what Our command comes, and (water) gushes forth from the oven, take on board of each kind two, i.e., a male and a female of every species of animals, plants and fruits etc. He was also to carry his family, 4 \$' iy i except those thereof against whom the Word has already gone forth. } meaning, those whom Allah had already decreed were to be destroyed. These were the members of his family who did not believe in him, such as his son and his wife. And Allah knows best. 4 / • » (*f[ij ug'ki 4 And address Me not in favor of those who have done wrong Verily, they are to be drowned. } means, "when you witness the heavy rain falling, do not let yourself be overcome with compassion and pity for your people, or hope for more time for them so that they may believe, for I have decreed that they will be drowned and will die in their state of disbelief and wrongdoing.' The story has already been told in detail in Surah Hud, and there is no need to repeat it here J 4 02 II5 ik Jii kjlii' iu! vJ iSjyLl ty } 4 And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say: 'All the praise be to Allah, Who has saved m See volume five, the Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :25)

647 Surah 23. Al-Mu'minun (26-30) (Part-18) Allah tells us that Nuh, peace be upon him, invoked his Lord to help him against his people, as Allah mentions in another Ayah: 4 Then he invoked his Lord (saying): "I have been overcome, so help (me)!" [54:10]. Here he says: \$ dyjj ==> C, Cjj } 40 my Lord! Help me because they deny me. } At that point, Allah commanded him to build a boat and to make it strong and firm, and to carry therein of every kind two, i.e., a male and a female of every species of animals, plants and fruits etc. He was also to carry his family, 4 \$' iy i except those thereof against whom the Word has already gone forth. } meaning, those whom Allah had already decreed were to be destroyed. These were the members of his family who did not believe in him, such as his son and his wife. And Allah knows best. 4 / • » (*f[ij ug'ki 4 And address Me not in favor of those who have done wrong Verily, they are to be drowned. } means, "when you witness the heavy rain falling, do not let yourself be overcome with compassion and pity for your people, or hope for more time for them so that they may believe, for I have decreed that they will be drowned and will die in their state of disbelief and wrongdoing.' The story has already been told in detail in Surah Hud, and there is no need to repeat it here J 4 02 II5 ik Jii kjlii' iu! vJ iSjyLl ty } 4 And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say: 'All the praise be to Allah, Who has saved m See volume five, the Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :25)

648 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr usfrom tixe people who are wrongdoers.} This is like the Ayah: IjJ ilju v ^ # ii4=. cj ill u rfjff c^jl ijzj -jgj iand has appointed for you ships and cattle on which you ride In order that you may mount on their backs, and then may remember the favor ofyour Lord what you mount thereon, and say : "Glory to Him Who has subjected this to us, and we could never have it (by our efforts). And verily, to Our Lord ive indeed are to return!"} [43:12-14] So, certainly, Nuh adhered to what he was commanded, as Allah says elsewhere: "£4=»jt 36j} iAnd he said: "Embark therein: in the Name of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage..."[1 1:41] So Nuh mentioned Allah at the beginning of his journey and at the end, and Allah said: 4:f : % 4> £} yj jt> 4And say: 'My Lord! Cause me to land at a blessed landing place, for You are the Best of tlwse who bring to land.'" <4;i 4 L[] 4 Verily in this, there are indeed Aydt,} means in this event, which is the saving of the believers and the destruction of the disbelievers there are signs, i.e., clear evidence and proof that the Prophets speak the truth in the Message they bring from Allah, may He be exalted, and that Allah does what He wills, and He is able to do all things and knows all things. ifor sure We are ever putting (men) to the test.} means, "We try Our servants by means ofsending the Messengers."

649Surah 23. Al-Mu'minim (31-41) (Part-18) rtt mm1B4 V> bliiV) jdllJ jul\$ <jj)_A*J' ^V ^ ///^ >"" // ^V "ik * 0 "s^ti **'-*? &psa,£(ij2%(kisrf\$\$\$d\$ /> /'• • t">1*1*1 u^J , rr,o^J T*..C^~>4 'ij ^3j i ^ & tSi 0 %\ *. - ".**• >/ i <• ,// -• .-v' 0£ , -^s jj-A£- _y U •—J 'c ft uij ££ gft &£. ^ j>, ft > 4 ^ c; // / / / / '••'*< £»-' l*j L\$/ ' Jfy » / "J/ »., •-./ ?> **Z s^>j Ji c7A.sJJ3iH^*> ^ i-*^ 1i- - . •> U-t Jb Uj 'djA]0Ac£0> -;> -r, , .:,c",'-f^ • *-• .? Jla 0_>uj UjJyvoi' 'i? 4*:*» oi GL' (4^ x4j (4^- Ei«jS -g.<V-' 4j«. aJ £ _£j ll ilii 1>jlc' ^ i^i StJ' Jlij ,TT ,Cjy£j ^Ai' "> ^>y • JI/^ ^ »A .uL i^iSj !i/»j cyN alii jgaj 4 ^jfc iL j^t jdk ^ 4> u£ c ^4. '-riAU 'oft Then, after them, We created another generation> 432 .>W We se/if to f/iew a Messengerfrom among themselves (saying) : "Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqiva?"} 433 . And the chiefs ofhis people who disbelieved and denied the meeting in the Hereafter, and whom We had given the luxuries and comforts of worldly life, said: "He is no more than a human being like you, he eats of that which you eat, and drinks ofwhat you drink."> 434. "If you were to obey a human being like yourselves, then verily, you indeed would be losers '>

meaning, very unlikely. 4He is only a man who has invented a lie against Allah,} meaning, 'in the Message he has brought to you, and his warnings and promise of resurrection.' r' o>j iand ive are not going to believe in him. He said "O my Lord! Help me because they deny me."} meaning, the Messenger prayed against his people and asked his Lord to help him against them. His Lord answered his prayer: 4 fJi iLc Jli^ i(Alldh) said: "In a little while, they are sure to be regretful."} meaning, 'for their opposition towards you and their stubborn rejection of the Message you brought to them.' 4So, The Sayhah overtook them in truth,} meaning, they deserved that from Allah because of their disbelief and wrongdoing. The apparent meaning is that the Sayhah was combined with the furious cold wind, tjjr 4Destroying everything by the command of its Lord! So they became such that nothing could be seen except their dwellings!} [46:25] iand We made them as rubbish ofdead plants.} means, they are dead and destroyed, like the scum and rubbish left by a flood, i.e., something insignificant and useless that is of no benefit to anyone. iSo, aivay with the people who are wrongdoers.} As Allah's statement:

<%)*£& £WSj&&6> 4We wronged them not, but they were the wrongdoers [43:76] means, who are wrongdoers because of their disbelief and stubborn opposition to the Messenger of Allah, so let those

who hear this beware of disbelieving in their Messengers. ly l+U-1 ;J C ls^ liLii'^ uXiLa ^ £\$:j*f tdA-53 £ c#& Oij 442. 77ien, after them, We created other generations .} 443. No nation can advance their term, nor can they delay it.} 444. Then We sent Our Messengers in succession. Every time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him; so, We made them follow one another, and We made them as Ahadith. So, away with a people who believe not!} Mention of Other Nations Allah says: u fc*& iThen, after them, We created other generations.} meaning, nations and peoples. 4No nation can advance their term, nor can they delay it.} means, they are taken at the appropriate time, as decreed by Allah in His Book that is preserved with Him, before they were created, nation after nation, century after century, generation after generation, successors after predecessors. 4% QLj G\$ y} iThen We sent Our Messengers in succession.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "(This means) following one another in succession." ' This is like the Ayah [i] At-Tabari 19:34.

4Jii ,4Li ^ Vjiy iil J-^= 4 t-jl 4 iliLidl jJc oil > : <• >i{ l*+y *«' iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah, and avoid Taghiit (all false deities)." Then of them were some whom Allah guided and of them were some upon whom the straying was justified (16:36). 4%T dfi3% u iEvery time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him;} meaning the greater majority of them. This is like the Ayah: 4 /•.*of.y^.—j .a, VI Ij L jLoJI (Jc 4A/as /or mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} [36:30] iso We made them follow one another,} means, We destroyed them,' as Allah says: iAnd how many generations have We destroyed after Nuh!} [17:17] }and We made them as Ahadith} meaning, stories and lessons for mankind, as Allah says elsewhere: iso, We made them as tales (in the land), and We dispersed them all totally} [34:19]. ^r*. Cj>Ji5Sa U l'ij Vj)Ui // <jrdlc. Cj \y6j 445. Then We sent Musa and his brother Harun, with Our

654 TafsTr IbtI Katltir Aydt and manifest authority, 446. To Fir'awn and his chiefs, but they behaved insolently and they were people self-exalting (by disobeying their Lord).} 447. They said: "Shall we believe in two men like ourselves, and their people are obedient to us zoith humility!"} 448. So, they denied them both and became of those who were destroyed.} 449. And indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, that they may be guided.} The Story of Musa, Peace be upon Him; and Fir'awn Allah tells us that He sent Musa, peace be upon him, and his brother Harun to Fir'awn and his chiefs with decisive evidence and definitive proof, but Fir'awn and his people were too arrogant to follow them and obey their commands because they were human beings, just as previous nations had denied the Message of the human Messengers. They were of a similar mentality, so Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his chiefs, drowning them all in one day. He revealed the Book to Musa, i.e., the Tawrah, in which were rulings, commands and prohibitions, after He had destroyed Fir'awn and the Egyptians and seized them with a punishment of the All-Mighty, All-Capable to carry out what He wills. After Allah revealed the Tawrah, Allah did not destroy any nation with an overwhelming calamity; instead, He commanded the believers to fight the disbelievers, as He says: iJXJtj ^ 4 "i s 4And indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember.} [28:43] j\? v'-> JJ*J +-A+ J-O'j u*' And We made the son of Maryam and his mother as a sign, and We gave them refiige on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr, and Ma'Tn.}

655 Surah 23. Al-Mu'minun (50) (Part-18) 'Isa and Maryam Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger 'Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon them both, and that He made them as a sign for mankind, i.e., definitive proof of His ability to do what He wills. For He created Adam without a father or a mother. He created Hawwa' from a male without a female, and He created Isa from a female without a male, but He created the rest of mankind from both male and female. yir* V 1-1 }ji> J, ^ iand We gave them refuge on high ground, a place of rest, security and flowing streams.} Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "Ar-Rabwah is a raised portion of land, which is the best place for vegetation to grow." ' This was also the view of Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah.¹² ' Ibn 'Abbas said, iDhdt Qadr} "A fertile place. iand Ma'fn} means water running on the surface."¹³ This was also the view of Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah.¹⁴ ' Mujahid said: "A level hill."¹⁵ ' Said bin Jubayr said that JIA iDhdt Qadr and Ma'in} means that water was flowing gently through it. Mujahid and Qatadah said: iand Ma'in } "Running water."¹⁶ 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6:100. 121 At-Tabari 5:536, 537. 131 At-Tabari 19:38. At-Tabari 19:39. At-Tabari 19:38. At-Tabari 19:39.

Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Satd bin Al-Musayyib: JJ* fj>J jt ^ iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in .} "It is Damascus."¹ 11 He said; "Something similar was also narrated from 'Abdullah bin Salam, Al-Hasan, Zayd bin Aslam and Khalid bin Ma'dan." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from 'Ikrimah from Ibn 'Abbas that this Ayah referred to the rivers of Damascus.²¹ Layth bin Abi Sulaym narrated from Mujahid that the words; iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah,} referred to Isa bin Maryam and his mother when they sought refuge in Damascus and the flatlands around it.' 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: ion a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in.}, "It is Ramlah in Palestine." The most correct opinion on this matter is that which was reported by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas, who said; \y**?0 JJ* v'i dl £&} '*>^ iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in.} "Ma'in refers to running water, and is the river of which Allah mentioned: iyour Lord has provided a ivater stream under you.>"[19:24] Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said; ion a high ground, a place of rest, security and flowing streams.} 111 At-Tabari 19:37. Al-Qurtubi 12:126. '3| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 : 100

lr^ h TiO jL4ii^S iliju ;cijs' aUJjs^istr*££-*3' ^t^o^5>y^^-x»~*<±*jO "e^O jli^L0xA& diL !\$!:£ lj>>cj cj)Jif-y^jLd -liij " ,"? r-" •r.r-'w'^i' *'A'"—.: r^JyV 4-2* i4_*ij*>*< . p^=tyti'j3-U.^ ij| p^JeqjLju 'A'7>r *-"" r— -**?- (U^Vri^J* Lr'j(vrf'.^V,i>»Ja43i^ 0>siU i"-?^ > ^ •.'i frTh . .' » > " 1 !{ S »*/ « /t /vf-* */ i /> 'VSVL '*J 1 • l*A ' < v7.' • *>7> ,<? ^ ^ ' >> > ci|V*^L-> cA^J taj ju> ^/ VT^* / -*" ^ • ,/ /.<' refers to Jerusalem. This -and Allah knows best - is the most apparent meaning, because it is mentioned in the other Ayah, and parts of the Qur'an explain other parts, so it is more appropriate to interpret it by another Ayah, then the Sahih. Hadiths, then other reports. v~W' oi \$ J-y» oJH ti, 41 \ptj 3 m 2;j± olj : }~ ,_*} , p==Ly U'j tj^ y ifi 'frif. J\$ \£zi •> . : • , ' ^ ' • /f ,y 3T-, p-f%JU W ^ A^ t , - ' -* ^y » ^ .-“JvCfir Ci*" >£/* J // V ,CA^J ^ «A Ljl v i 4 £ If 4^/i 451 . O Messengers! Eat of the Tayyibat and do righteous deeds. Verily, I am Well-Acquainted with what you do. 452. And verily, this your religion is one religion, and I am your Lord, so have Taqwa."} 453. But they have broken their religion among them into sects, each group rejoicing in what is with it. 454. So, leave them in their error for a time.} 455. Do they think that in wealth and children with which We prolong them} 456. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.}

The Command to eat Lawful Food and to do Righteous Deeds Allah commands His servants and Messengers, peace be upon them all, to eat lawful food and do righteous deeds, which indicates that eating what is lawful helps one to do righteous deeds. The Prophets, peace be upon them, did this in the most perfect manner, and did all kinds of good deeds in words, actions, guidance and advice. May Allah reward them with good on behalf of the people. iEat of the Tayyibafy Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak said, "This means lawful. In the Sahih it says: ^ JA Uj» «There is no Prophet who was not a shepherd.» They asked, "And you, O Messenger ofAllah?" He said, liks jiN Sfj* Jif- UUji dIS "Yes, I used to tend the sheep of the people ofMakkah for afew Qirats.^ I] In the Sahih, it says: <t»ju I* jsb dj. ij is !j)> «Dawud, upon him be peace, used to eatfrom the earnings of his own hand.^ It was recorded in Sahih Muslim, JamV At-Tirmidhi and Musnad Al-Imam Ahmad - from whom this version comes - that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: JiyiUj JI Sll Sp iCt V1 V IS il Si >liJl 1\$ U» «0 people, Allah is Tayyib and only accepts that which is Tayyib, and Allah commands the believers as He had l1 ' Al-Bukhari no. 2226, Ibn Majah 2 :727. A Qirat is one-twentieth, or a bit more , ofa Dinar. 121 Fath Al-Bari4 :355

659Surah 23. Al-Mu'minin (51-56) (Part-18) commanded the Messengers by saying >&£ ll, ji \pij cSp S- % gfi 40 Messengers! Eat of the Tayyibdt and do righteous deeds. Verily, 1 am Well-Acquainted with what you do. [23:51] and 40 you who believe! Eat of the Tayyibdt that We have provided you with} [2:172)j Then he mentioned how a man may travel on a long journey, dusty and unkempt, j! ("Sr^S ("S">*- ij U ^ U : wnd his food, drink and clothing are unlawful, and he has nourished himself with what is utilazofid, and he extends his hands towards the sky, saying, 'O Lord, O Lord!' - how can his prayer be answered .»II! At-Tirmidhi said that it is "Hasan Gharib." The Religion of all the Prophets is Tawhid; and the

Warning against splitting into different Groups

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3824–3846]

4And verily, this your religion is one religion, means, "your religion, O Prophets, is one religion and one group, which is the call to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate.' Allah said: u ^4; 4and I am your Lord, so have Taqwa.4 We have already discussed this in Surat Al-Anbiya'.W The phrase 4one nation^ is descriptive. Muslim 1 :703 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :335, Ahmad 2 :328 ^ See volume six, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya" (2 1 :92).

iBut they have broken their religion among them into sects,} the nations towhom Prophets were sent. ieach group rejoicing in what is with it.} means, they rejoice in their misguidance because they think that they are rightly-guided. Allah says, threatening and warning: %^} <\$So, leave them in their error meaning their misguidance, ifor a time.} means, until the appointed time of their destruction comes. This is like the Ayah: & o^3f&} 4So give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them for a while.} [86:17] And Allah saysa.yo Jp ^s>} iLeave them to eat and enjoy, and let them be preoccupied with (false) hope. They will come to bww!} [15:3] / -.'w. *>" * / E 'Vj> . •/. > // > /'if >/< i 4Do they think that in wealth and children with which We prolong them, We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} means, 'do these deceived people think that what We give them of wealth

and children is because they are honored and precious in Our sight? No, the matter is not as they claim when they say, 'We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished.' [34:35]

But this thinking is wrong, and their hopes will be dashed. We only give those things to them in order to make them go further (in sin) and to give them more time.' Allah says: 'But they perceive not.' as He says elsewhere: 'So, let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world...' [9:55] 'We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness' [3:178]. 'Then leave Me Alone with such as belie this Qur'an. We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not. And I will grant them a respite.' [68:44-45] 'Leave Me Alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely.' until His saying: 'Opposing' [74:11-16] 'And it is not your wealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us, but only he who believes, and does righteous deeds...' [34:37] And there are many other Ayat which say similar things. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah said:

662 Tafstr Ibn Kathir [J>- jfffi Vj 'Jj aAs jj-Lj Xp j^LIj ^ ;X; OjUj" «A//fl! /ws distributed your behavior to you just as He has distributed your provision. Allah gives the things of this world to those whom He loves and those whom He does not love, but He only gives religious commitment to those whom He loves. Whoever is given religious commitment by Allah is loved by Him. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, no servant truly submits until his heart and his tongue submit, and he does not truly believe until his neighbor is safe from his harm.» They said, 'What is his harm, O Messenger of Allah?' He said, 'His wrongdoing and misbehavior. No person who earns unlawful wealth and spends it will be blessed in that; if he gives it in charity, it will not be accepted from him and if he leaves it behind (when he dies), it will be his provision in the Fire. Allah does not wash away an evil deed with another, but he washes away evil deeds with good deeds, for impurity cannot wash away with another impurity.'™ j*rj > ' • • •>-» ti ' •>> *.' ; Ci- ' i:* 'If' S- s' 's'\ m •/ (*rJ j) |*r' prA> !A ^ »«« K / n •>". 7 457. Verily, those who live in awe for fear of their Lord;} 458. And those who believe in the Ayat of their Lord;} 459. And those who join not anyone as partners with their Lord;} 460. And those who give that which they give with their hearts hi Ahmad 1:387. The authentic narration of this text is from Ibn Mas'ud not the Prophet

full of fear, because they are sure to return to their Lord.} 461. It is these who listen in to the good deeds, and they are foremost in them.} Description of the People of Good Deeds iVerily, those who live in awe for fear of their Lord;} means, even though they have reached the level of Ihsan and have faith and do righteous deeds, they are still in awe of Allah and fear Him and His hidden plans for them, as Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "The believer combines Ihsan with awe, while the disbelievers combine evil deeds with a sense of security."11 4And those who believe in the Ayat of their Lord;} means, they believe in His universal and legislative signs, as Allah says about Maryam, peace be upon her: 'and she testified to the truth of the Words of her Lord, and His Scriptures' [66: 12], meaning that she believed that whatever existed was by the will and decree of Allah, and that whatever Allah decreed, if it was a command, it would be something that He liked and accepted; if it was a prohibition, it would be something that He disliked and rejected; and if it was good, it would be true. This is like the Ayah 4And

those who join not anyone (in worship) as partners with their Lord;} meaning, they do not worship anyone or anything else besides Him, but they worship Him Alone and know that there is no god except Allah Alone, the One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who does not take a wife or have any offspring, and there is m At-Tabari 19:45.

\$ki*?-(»ty 1P'*Eoj&ouJ[\$ > //« . 'z*s': '<' i / • , ^ . , / > ^ | ^ \$ Q ^ l « * £ J j J t o i l S c l > , ? & * ' > 390 ^ - i * t - T ' • , • > • is " . ' ' • f v £ ! S j j V ' (t l t t i C « ' « * • » £ * < # / * ^ > - > * ' t * C s > * m ' + \ i r ^ % j ^ T U A / ^ s M y j * " u , » J » * U - i) i 4 i » - ^ 4 j j ^ y L > > 1 " • * < * > • > r ^ t V v • " " > ! ; ? • ' T a f e f r I b n K a t h i r n o n e c o m p a r a b l e o r e q u a l u n t o H i m . 4 A n d t h o s e w h o g i v e t h a t w h i c h t h e y g i v e w i t h t h e i r h e a r t s f a l l o f f e a r , b e c a u s e t h e y a r e s u r e t o r e t u r n t o t h e i r L o r d . m e a n s , t h e y g i v e i n c h a r i t y , f e a r i n g t h a t i t m a y n o t b e a c c e p t e d f r o m t h e m b e c a u s e o f s o m e s h o r t c o m i n g o r f a i l u r e t o m e e t t h e r e q u i r e d c o n d i t i o n s o f g i v i n g . T h i s h a s t o d o w i t h f e a r a n d t a k i n g p r e c a u t i o n s , a s I m a m A h m a d r e c o r d e d f r o m ' A ' i s h a h : I s a i d : " O M e s s e n g e r o f A l l a h , i t j & Z 3 i > : ' J & 4 A n d t h o s e w h o g i v e t h a t w h i c h t h e y g i v e w i t h t h e i r h e a r t s f i l l o f f e a r . . . } A r e t h e s e t h e o n e s w h o s t e a l a n d c o m m i t Z i n a , a n d d r i n k a l c o h o l w h i l e f e a r i n g A l l a h ? " T h e M e s s e n g e r o f A l l a h g g r e p l i e d : j b j ^ . i . s 2 " u j u f t t < u j U I c ^ j U i V B i ^ ^ ^ I ' « J i r j ' j i - « u l i J U J « N o , O d a u g h t e r o f A b u B a k r . O d a u g h t e r o f A s - S i d d i q , t h e o n e w h o p r a y s , f a s t a n d g i v e s i n c h a r i t y , f e a r i n g A l l a h . » (1 1 m A h m a d 6 : 1 5 9 .

665Siirah 23. Al-Mu'minun (62-67) (Part-18) This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded something similar in which the Prophet jg said: "4o&' ^ tpd' »No, O daughter ofAs-Siddiq, they are the ones who pray and fast and give in charity whilefearing that it will not be accepted from them, ilt is these who hasten in the good deeds.} This is also how Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and Al-Hasan Al-Basri interpreted this Ayah)J* <j Ji V >j Qj) l+ljj Lli (* rtV'* '* 3*^ ^ (**^ o/j j; jjij ijCfc ff jj V ll* fZi\ jjJl ij^jt V {ii 'iyjlk 4 'v . Ir" —• . V> , 462. And We task not any person except according to his capacity, and with Us is a Record which speaks the truth, and they will not be wronged. 463. Nay, but their hearts are coveredfrom this, and they have other deeds, besides which they are doing.} 464. Until when We seize those of them who lead a luxurious life with punishment; behold, they make humble invocation ivith a loud voice.} 465. Invoke not loudly this day! Certainly you shall not be helped by Us.} 466. Indeed My Aydt used to be recited to you, but you used to turn back on your heels.} 467. In pride, talking evil about it by night.} The Justice ofAllah and the Frivolity ofthe Idolators Allah tells us of His justice towards His servants in this world, in that He does not task any person except according to his capacity, i.e., He does not burden any soul with more than it can bear. On the Day of Resurrection He will call them to m At-Tabari 19:45, 46.

account for their deeds, which He has recorded in a written Book from which nothing is omitted. He says: ipi&&m> iand with Us is a Record which speaks the truth,} meaning, the Book ofdeeds 4& iand they will not be wronged.} means, nothing will be omitted from their record of good deeds. As for evil deeds, He will forgive and overlook many of them in the case of His believing servants. Then Allah says, denouncing the disbelievers and idolators of the Quraysh: i)> 4 Jfr iNay, but their hearts are covered}, meaning because of negligence and misguidance, ifrom this.} means, the Qur'an which Allah revealed to His Messenger sg. iand they have other deeds, besides which they are doing.} Al-Hakam bin Aban narrated from Ikrimah, from Ibn 'Abbas that iand they have other deeds,} means, evil deeds apart from that, i.e., Shirk, £} iivhich they are doing.} means, which they will inevitably do. This was

also narrated from Mujahid, Al-Hasan and others. Others said that this phrase means: Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 : 107 . 121 At-Jabari 19:49, Al-Qurtubi 12:134.

they have other deeds, besides which they are doing.} It was decreed that they would do evil deeds, and they will inevitably do them before they die, so that the word of punishment may be justified against them. A similar view was narrated from Muqatil bin Hayyan, As- Suddi and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. This is a clear and appropriate meaning. We have already quoted from the Hadith of Ibn Mas'ud: *~i Oj£-l jj S‘ 7s- <J] V ji l j0l JaI JTSj i\lj] VI “By Him besides Wlw m there is no other God, a man may do the deeds of the people of Paradise until there is no more than a forearm's length between him and it, then the decree will overtake him and he will do the deeds of the people of Hell, then he will enter Hell > ./,<• # 1 ^ //M •”> /*/{ ^ . , iUntil when We seize those of them who lead a luxurious life with punishment; behold, they make humble invocation with a loud voice.} means, when the punishment and vengeance of Allah comes to those who are living a happy life of luxury in this world and overtakes them, ibehold, they make humble invocation with a loud voice.} means, they scream their calls for help. This is like the Ayat. 4And leave Me Alone (to deal) with the beliers, those who are in possession of good things of life. And give them respite for a little while. Verily, with Us are fetters, and a raging Fire.} [73:11-12] At-Tabari 19:50. 121 Ahmad 1 :382

He said, “They boasted about the Ka’bah and said, “We are its people who stay up talking at night.’ They used to boast and stay up and talk at night around the Ka’bah. They did not use it for the proper purpose, and so in effect they had abandoned it.”¹¹¹ 2& \ ifIgs \$ \$ u >fC \EZ iBI> gr £ ,s>; ;; o* (*4^ j? J-J JyV!> Jh j*j J* '-i 0 (*+£•* % £ 0 ^ V S|f \$ A*5vOH—. (*^d» 4 1>*»U Oi (+£ t. Liis, 468 . Have they not pondered over the Word, or has there come to them w lmt had not come to their fathers of old?} 469. Or is it that they did not recognize their Messenger so they deny him? 470. Or they say: There is madness in him? Nay, but he brought them the truth, but most of them are averse to the truth .} 471 . And if Al-Haqq had followed their desires, verily, the heavens and the earth, and whosoever is therein would have been corrupted! Nay, We have brought them their reminder, but they turn away from their reminder. 472. Or is it that you ask them for some Kharj? But the recompense of your Lord is better, and He is the Best of those who give sustenance . 473. And certainly, you call them to the straight path.} 474. And verily, those who believe not in the Hereafter are indeed deviating far astray from the path.} 475. And though We had mercy on them and removed the distress which is on them, still they would obstinately persist in their transgression, wandering blindly.} m An-Nasat in Al-Kubrd 6 :412

Refutation and Condemnation of the Idolators Allah denounces the idolators for not understanding the Qur’an or contemplating its meaning, and for turning away from it, even though they had been addressed specifically in this Book which Allah did not reveal to any Messenger more perfect and noble, and especially since no Book or wamer had come to their forefathers who had died during the Jahiliyyah. What these people, upon whom the blessing had been bestowed, should have done, was to accept it and give thanks for it, and try to understand it and act in accordance with it night and day, as was done by the wise ones among them who became Muslim and followed the Messenger jfe, may Allah be pleased with them. iHave they not pondered over the Word,} Qatadah said, “Because, by Allah, if the people had pondered the meaning and understood it properly, they would have found in the Qur’an a deterrent to disobeying Allah. But they only paid attention to the Ayat which are not entirely

clear, and so they were destroyed because of that.”^ Then Allah says, denouncing the disbelievers of the Quraysh: 3& p£> iOr is it that they did rtot recognize their Messenger so they deny him?} means, ‘do they not recognize Muhammad and the honesty, trustworthiness and good character with which he grew up among them? Can they deny that or argue against it?’ JaTar bin Abi Talib said to An-Najashi, the king of Ethiopia: “O King, Allah has sent to us a Messenger whose lineage, honesty and trustworthiness are known to us.”*21 Al-Mughlrah bin Shu‘bah said something similar to the deputy of Kisra when he wanted to challenge him. When the Byzantine ruler Heraclius asked Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb and his companions - who were Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:110. 121 Ibn Hisham 1 :357

671Surah 23. Al-Mu'minim (68-75) (Part-18) still disbelievers and had not yet become Muslim - about the characteristics, lineage, honesty and trustworthiness of the Prophet sg, they could only tell the truth and admit that he was indeed noble and truthful.111 i% ft iOr they say: There is madness in him?} This is a narration of what the Quraysh said about the Prophet jg. They said that he was making up the Qur'an by himself, or that he was crazy and did not know what he was saying. Allah tells us that their hearts did not believe that, they knew that what they were saying about the Qur'an was falsehood, for it had come to them from the Words of Allah and could not be resisted or rejected. So Allah challenged them and all the people of the world to produce something like it if they could - but they could not and would never be able to do so. So Allah says: 4**^s ft 4Nay, but he brought them Al-Haqq, but most of them are averse to the truth.} Truth does not followWhims and Desires Allah says; & J&b fix# M 4And ifAl-Haqq had followed their desires, verily, the heavens and the earth, and ivhosoever is therein would have been corrupted!} Mujahid, Abu Salih and As-Suddi said, “Al-Haqq is Allah, may He be glorified.”121 What is meant by the Ayah is that if Allah had responded to the desires in their hearts and prescribed things accordingly, the heavens and the earth and whosoever is therein, would have been corrupted, i.e., because oftheir corrupt and inconsistent desires. As Allah says ofthem elsewhere: Fath Al-Bari 1 :42. At-Tabari 19 :57, Al-Qurtubi 12:140.

i:k^ U £ SOW 3\$V} 4“Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the two towns?”} [43:31] Then He says: 4%j jfLg \$} 41s it they who would portion out the mercy of your Lord?} [43:32] And Allah says: . /‘ / ** //*/ 1 • / , / »// /A/ #/ •>{ « >\ <•. l>~ 'j} ZiJ **-*y ij;!)-*" Ji^> 4Say: "If you possessed the treasure of the mercy ofmy Lord, then you would surely hold back for fear of spending it."} [17:100], 4 l«S iPw* Syit i U| 40r Jun?e they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a NaqTrP j> [4:53] All of this goes to show how incapable mankind is and how divergent and inconsistent their ideas and desires are. Only Allah, may He be glorified, is Perfect in all His attributes, words, actions, laws, power and control of His creation, may He be exalted and sanctified. There is no God but He and no Lord besides Him. Then He says: 4Nay, We have brought them their reminder,} meaning the Qur'an, £ 7^} ibut they turn awayfrom their reminder.} The speck on the back of a date stone. See the commentary of this Ayah in volume two

673Surah 23. Al-Mu'minim (68-75) (Part-18) The Prophet sg does not ask for any payment, and he calls to the straight path. iOr is it that you ask than for some Kharj?) Al-Hasan said, “A reward.” Qatadah said, “Some payment.”21 4Bid the recompense ofyour Lord is better,\$ means, you are not asking for any wages or payment or anything for calling them to right guidance, rather you are hoping for a great reward from Allah, as He says: iSay : “Whatever wage I might have asked ofyou is yours. My wage

is from Allah only.") iSay : "No wage do I ask of you for this, nor am I one of the pretenders.") [38 :86
 <i iyyii vi y 4Say : "No reward do I ask of you for this except to be kind to me for my kinship with you.")
 [42 :23 y*-' V <y \$2*3® Jii &&& CJ 4And there came a man naming from the farthest part of the
 town. He said: "O my people! Obey the Messengers. Obey those who ask no ivages of you, and who are
 rightly guided.") [35 :20-21] 4 V di' # fire atyjf At-Jabari 19:58. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:110.

)And certainly, you call than to the straight path. And verily, those ivho believe not in the Hereafter are
 indeed deviating far astray from the path.) The Situation of the Disbelievers 4: 'i cSk iAtid verily, those
 ivho believe not in the Hereafter are indeed deviating far astray from the path.) meaning, they have gone
 astray and deviated. OJ. j Jt rH 6 r&v Jo) iAnd though We had mercy on them and removed the distress
 which is on than, still they would obstinately persist in their transgression, wandering blindly.) Here
 Allah tells of their stubbornness in their disbelief, in that even if He had removed the calamity from
 them and made them understand the Qur'an, they still would not follow it; they would still persist in
 their disbelief and stubborn transgression. This is like the Ayat. Jt&Li s' > >' jrj j re* ^ 'S-&))Had Allah
 known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even if He had made them
 listen, they ivould but have turned away with aversion.) [8:23] j; Cli iii Jc 1jiJ> ISj fj) \yf- Q IjjU ijij j
 Jj jj CiyCc U pli '1. 4And if (Lauw) you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They
 will say: "Would that we ivere but sent back (to the ivorld)! Then we would not da\y the Aydt of our
 Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to than what they had been
 concealing before. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which
 they were forbidden.) [6:27-29] Until His statement:

675 Surah 23, Al-Mu'mitun (76-83) (Part-18) rJl mm* rtv x xx / // // x#xx x i/ x x/ JyJ—icjUc
 ljUUj>1llcli3Cili|tsa'^ tfeVi, o^4; 3i3CjylS\$,< ,^r//>*-i/• > "ItA ">*A >4«s, "£ ,>=< x > ^ *. -'•>,*.
 Hf (Lauw)} is something that will never happen." i*i h^IAiJU Ji)j^ Cj j^p, // / // // /•// ' i/ li Cl#
 fipClJLC *j £ ty jkiAi £*tf p til aii £ < / ' ' > ,/ / ,< V/ U yji -#J^b ii; ^ u\$ xi 4; ^ «£ ji; ^£2 fg m.g tffi id
 C Ji* ijiii j; -SSI jCffi \$ \ <%£\$ k4W mz ti\ a& '•\$'. *.ic* ^\>-" &\'. *!•''* *S 4be resurrected} This has
 to do with the knowledge of Allah. He knows about some- thing that will not happen, but if it were to
 happen, He knows how it would be. Ad- Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "Every- thing that is
 implied in the word: 476. And indeed We seized them with punishment, but they humbled not
 themselves to their Lord, nor did they invoke with submission to Him.} 477. Until, when We open for
 them the gate of severe punishment, then lo! they will be plunged in despair.} 478. It is He Who has
 created for you hearing, eyes, and hearts. Little thanks you give.} 479. And it is He Who has created
 you on the earth, and to

Him you shall be gathered back .} 480. And it is He Who gives life and causes death, and His is the
 alternation of night and day. Will you not then understand?} 481 . Nay, but they say the like of ivhat the
 men of old said. 482. They said: "When we are dead and have become dust and bones, shall we be
 resurrected indeed?"} 483. "Verily, this we have been promised - we and our fathers before! This is only
 (from) tales of the ancients!"} Allah's saying: 4And indeed We seized them with punishment,} means,
 'We tried and tested them with difficulties and calamities.' His saying: Uj {3} 4but they humbled not
 themselves to their Lord, nor did they invoke x with submission to Him.} means, that did not deter them
 from their disbelief and resistance, rather they persisted in their sin and misguidance, 4\$&J G} 4but

they humbled not themselves} C,} 4nor did they invoke (Allah) with submission to Him.} they did not call on Him. This is like the Ayah: 4££ jCJJ OX ^Xr H%} 4When Our torment reached them, why then did they not humble themselves? But their hearts became hardened,} [6 :43 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Abu Sufyan came to the Messenger of Allah and said, ‘O Muhammad, I ask you by Allah and by the ties of kinship between us, we have been reduced to eating camel hair and blood.’ Then Allah revealed,

iAnd indeed We seized them ivith punishment, but they humbled not themselves.> This was also recorded by An-Nasal. 1 11 The basis of this Hadith is in the Two Sahihs, where it says that the Messenger of Allah sg prayed against the Quraysh when he could not make any headway with them, and he said, “O Allah, help me against them sending on them seven years (offamine) like the seven (years of drought) of Ytlsuf. »,2) iUntil, when We open for them the gate of severe punishment, then lo! they will be plunged in despair . When the command of Allah reaches them and the Hour comes to them suddenly, and they are overtaken by the punishment of Allah which they were not expecting, then they will despair of any ease and goodness, and all their hopes will disappear. A reminder of the Blessings of Allah and His immense Power Then Allah mentions His blessings to His servants, in that He has given them hearing, sight and understanding through which they come to know things and draw lessons from them, the signs which attest to the Oneness of Allah and indicate that He is the OneWho does what He wills and chooses what He wants. iLittle thanks you give means, how little you thank Allah for the blessings He has given you. This is like the Ayuh: iAnd most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly> [12:103] An-Nasa"! in Al-Kubra 6:413. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :435 , Muslim 4 :2156

679Siirah 23. Al-Mu'minun (84-90) (Part-18 shall we be resurrected indeed?"} They thought it very unlikely that this would happen after they had disintegrated into nothing. 4"Verily, this we have been promised - we and our fathers before (us)! Tins is only the tales of the ancients!"} This means, “It is impossible that we could be brought back. This was said by those who learned it from the books and disputes of the ancients.” This denial and rejection on their part is like the Ayah where Allah tells us about them: lili j--j ‘srj-j j> v-£ tlie dT 4"Even after we are crumbled bones?" They say: "It would in that case, be a rehim with loss!" But it zoill be only a single ZajrahJ 71 Wheti behold, they find themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.} [79:11-14] i-j yT. lj cjff) ji— ijji ill2 j-ilid. lS' cd-iy' fy} j*j }j \$ ULiil Zs\$ Ji 'vA, jL-jj ifd J* i3li /id. v 0 4Does nof /non see that We have created him from Nutfah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knoiver of every creation!"} [36:77-79] Ji aU Ji ^ See the comments on Surat An-Nazi'at (79:13) and Surat As-Saffat * This was explained earlier. See Surat Al-Hajj (22 :4), and Surat Al-Mu'minun (23 : 13)

680 TafsJr Ibn Kathir . . - ^ vj jX-f. J(y ^L=. iJCu o i>\$ jl j* <i ifTfoyJCZ Say: "Whose is the earth and whosoever is therein? Ifyou know!"} 485. They will say: "It is Allah's!" Say: "Will you not then remember?"} 486. Say: "Who is (the) Lord of the seven heavens, and (the) Lord of the Great Throne?"} 487 . They will say: "Allah." Say: "Will you not then have Taqwa?"} 488. Say: "In Wlwse Hand is the

sovereignty of everything? And He protects, while against Whom there is no protector, if you know?"}

489. They will say: "(All that belongs) to Allah." Say: "How then are you deceived and him away from the truth?"}

490. Nay, but We have brought them the truth, and verily, they are liars.} The Idolators believe in Tawhid Ar-Rububiyyah which requires them to believe in Tawhid Al-Uluhiyyah Allah states that the fact that He is One and that He is independent in His creation, control, dominion and guides one to realize that there is no God except Him and that none should be worshipped except Him Alone, with no partner or associate. He tells His Messenger Muhammad ﷺ to say to the idolators who worship others besides Him, even though they admit His Lordship, that He has no partner in Lordship. But despite this they still attributed partners in divinity to Him, and worshipped others besides Him even though they recognized the fact that those whom they worshipped could not create anything, did not own anything, nor do they have any control over anything. However, they still believed that these creatures could bring them closer to Allah, 4&J lit ^} 4We worship them only that they may bring us near to Allah} [39 :3],

681 Surah 23. Al-Mu'minun (84-90) (Part-18) So Allah says: iK.i£ JoVr p; fo iSay: "Whose is the earth and whosoever is therein?"} meaning, "Who is the Owner Who has created it and whatever is in it of animals, plants, fruits and all other kinds of creation?" i"If you know!" They will say: "It is Allah's!"} means, they will admit that this belongs to Allah Alone with no partner or associate. If that is the case, iSay: "Will you not then remember?"} that none should be worshipped except the Creator and Provider. 4# iSay: "Who is Lord of the seven heavens, and Lord of the Great Throne?"} means, "Who is the Creator of the higher realm with its planets, lights and angels who submit to Him in all regions and in all directions? Who is the Lord of the Great Throne, which is the highest of all created things?" Allah says here: (& iand Lord of the Great Throne}, meaning the Mighty Throne. At

the end of the Surah, Allah says:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3846–3857]

u£*S' ±v} 4the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} [23:116], meaning splendid and magnificent. The Throne combines the features of height and vastness with splendor and magnificence. This is why it was said that it is made of red rubies. Ibn Mas'ud said, "There is no night or day with your Lord, and the light of the Throne is from the Light of His Face." I 1 * Al-'Azamah no. 147, by Abu Ash-Shaykh. This narration is not authentic, however Muslim recorded a Hadith from the Prophet ﷺ that is somewhat similar in meaning. See the Book of Faith, the chapter ; "Did the Prophet ﷺ see his Lord?" Hadith no. 445

XJ' J» *u oyj*~*f 4They will say: "Allah." Say: "Will you not then have Taqwa?"} meaning, since you admit that He is the Lord of the heavens and the Lord of the Mighty Throne, will you not fear His punishment for worshipping others besides Him and associating others with Him? 4far J^=* .«Ju Cr4 ^Say: "In Whose Hand is the sovereignty of everything?"} i.e., sovereignty is in His Hands. V. y VI o; iThere is not a moving creature but He has grasp of its forelock [11:56]. meaning, He has control over it. The Messenger of Allah used to say, 5JU{ 'jJa j&j v» "By the One in Whose hand is my soul.* When he swore an oath, he would say, «By the One Who turns over (controls) the hearts .» He, may He be glorified, is the Creator, the Sovereign, the Controller, ^ a.% *4- iAnd He protects (all), while against

Whom there is no protector, if you know?} Among the Arabs, if a leader announced his protection to a person, no one could go against him in that, yet no one could offer protection against that leader. Allah says: 4<s ia.% 4And He protects (all), while against Whom there is no protector,} meaning, He is the greatest Master, and there is none greater

than Him. His is the power to create and to command, and none can overturn or oppose His ruling. What He wills happens, and what He does not, will not happen. Allah says: 4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} [21:23] He cannot be asked about what He does because of His greatness, Pride, overwhelming power, wisdom and justice, but all of His creation will be asked about what they did, as Allah says: 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} [15:92-93) 4They will say: "(All that belongs) to Allah."} means, they will admit that the Almighty Master Who protects all while against Him there is no protector is Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. 4Say: "How then are you deceived and turn away from the truth?"} means, how can your minds accept the idea of worshipping others besides Him when you recognize and acknowledge that? Then Allah says: 4Nay, but I've have brought them the truth,} which is the declaration that there is no god worthy of worship besides Allah, and the establishment of clear, definitive and sound proof to that effect, and verily, they are liars.} means, in their worship of others alongside Allah when they have no evidence for doing so, as Allah says at the end of this Surah:

rd 'mUShi riA 'JStBfJU //// /' < ^ c / ^ J^i-Lj J^ljsjj I j]aJ .A. ^ > ' ' < " » > > - ' To/sir Ibn Kathir iv_j;
Jp <jrul'UU ' " 1l- - ""ir>> ""-V\^- " rH >>*"•*.- < .-t,-r,< ^ >"-> s '.*s -" (^ -'*-s ^ ^ ^0<EiA^fi4^2^i^2
s"" . * > x /. V JiJ. L-J-iJj 4i\ £* £Jj xa L*5li a) dA^f v ;*J <And whoever invokes, besides Allah, any
other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers
will not be successful . [23:1 17J The idolators have no evidence for what they are doing, which has led
them into lies and misguidance. Rather they are following their forefathers and predecessors who were
confused and ignorant, as Allah describes them: 4 if dlj iil jlt fcf; l Jwj A "We found our fathers
folloxxing a certain way and religion, and we will indeedfolloxxv their footsteps "\$ [43:23] S^~ jf 4->jj
i&l & fM ^J^s=> Cj Jbj ii> Jk_jef <91 . No son (or offspring) did Allah beget, nor is there any god
along with Him . (If there had been many gods), then each god would have taken away what he had
created, and some would have tried to overcome others! Glorified be Allah above all that they attribute
to Him!\$

685Surah 23. Al-Mu'minun (91-92) (Part-18) i92. All-Knmver of the unseen and the seen! Exalted be
He over all that they associate as partners to Him/\$> Allah has no Partner or Associate Allah declares
Himself to be above having any child or partner in dominion, control and worship. He says: yj, jii.
\\j^X -U 'ij Cj & iNo son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along ivith Him (If there had been many
gods), then each god would have taken aivay what he had created, and some would have tried to
overcome others. meaning, if it were decreed that there should be a plurality of deities, each of them
would have exclusive control over whatever he had created, so there would never be any order in the
universe. But what we see is that the universe is ordered and cohesive, with the upper and lower realms
connected to one another in the most perfect fashion. oj 4^ o, ts) fy iyou can see no fault in the creation
of the Most Gracious [65:3]. Moreover, if there were a number of gods, each of them would try to
subdue the other with enmity, and one would prevail over the other. This has been mentioned by the

scholars of Rm-ul-KalamJ ' who discussed it using the evidence of mutual resistance or counteraction. This idea states that if there were two or more creators, one would want to make a body move while the other would want to keep it immobile, and if neither of them could achieve what they wanted, then both would be incapable, but the One Whose existence is essential [i.e., Allah] cannot be incapable. It is impossible for the will of both to be fulfilled because of the conflict. This dilemma only arises when a plurality of gods is suggested, so it is impossible for there to be such a plurality, because if the will of one is fulfilled and I 1 * A term used to denote the discipline of the Muslim scholars who utilized philosophy in their teachings

TheCommand to callonAllahwhenCalamity strikes, to repel Evil with that which is better, and to seek refuge with Allah Allah commands His Prophet Muhammad % to call on Him with this supplication when calamity strikes: iMy Lord! If You would show me that with which they are threatened. meaning, "if You punish them while I am witnessing that, then do not cause me to be one of them.' As was said in the Haclth recorded by Imam Ahmad and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Sahth: yJu 'fj. JllJ] yi If You loant to test people, then take me to You [cause me to die] without having to undergo the test.» ['] iAnd indeed We are able to show you that with which We have threatened them> means, 'if We willed, We could show you the punishment and test that We will send upon them.' Then Allah shows him the best way to behave when mixing with people, which is to treat kindly the one who treats him badly, so as to soften his heart and turn his enmity to friendship, and to turn his hatred to love. Allah says: iRepel evil with that which is better.\$ This is like the Ayah: dj r>J /cajj ijAjjj isji (>— Si\ iRepel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it except Ahmad 5 :243 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 : 108

those who are patient> [41:34-35). meaning, nobody will be helped or inspired to follow this advice or attain this quality, 4except those ivho are patient meaning, those who patiently bear people's insults and bad treatment and deal with them in a good manner when they are on the receiving end of bad treatment from them. 4^-J?*>> &>} iand none is granted it except the oivner of the great portion} means, in this world and the Hereafter. And Allah says: ^ Oi 4> \\$ <0 Jj} iAnd say: "My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the tohisperings of the Shayatin."} Allah commanded him to seek refuge with Him from the Shayatin, because no trick could help you against them and you cannot protect yourself by being kind to them. We have already stated, when discussing Isti'adhah (seeking refuge),¹¹¹ that the Messenger of Allah jfe used to say, "I seek refuge with Allah, the All-Hearing, All-Seeing, from the accursed Shayatin, from his ivhisperings, evil suggestions and insinuations His saying: / .. >>•' < . - < > 4" And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they should come near me."} means, in any issue of my life. So we are commanded to mention Allah at the beginning of any undertaking, in order to ward off the Shayatin at the time of eating, intercourse, See volume one, prior to the Tafsir of Surat Al-Fatihah. |2) Abu Dawud 1 :490.

689Siirah 23. Al-Mu'miniin (99-100) (Part-18) slaughtering animals for food, etc. Abu Dawud recorded that the Messenger of Allah used to say: Iri^ 3j^j k jiJ ir°- 3j*^j JCJt> a<>Oj 0 "O A//o/i, I seek refuge with You from old age, I seek refiige with You from being crushed or drowned, and I seek refiige ivith you from being assaulted by the Shayatin at the time of death, a' f.' T" ' 7'lr: " if 499. Until, when death comes to one of them, he says: "My Lord! Send me back,"} ilOO. "So that I may do good in that which

I have left behind!" No! (Kalla) It is but a word that he speaks; and in front of them is Barzakh until the Day when they will be resurrected.} The Disbelievers' Hope when death approaches Allah tells us about what happens when death approaches one of the disbelievers or one of those who have been negligent with the commands of Allah. He tells us what he says and how he asks to come back to this world so that he can rectify whatever wrongs he committed during his lifetime. Allah says: 4.y? 4"My Lord! Send me back, so that I may do good in that which I have left behind!" No!} This is like the Ayat icJfX OK J -Ojj }And spend of that with which VS!e have provided you before death comes to one of you,} until His saying: m Abu Dawud 2 :194

690 Tafsir Ibt Kathir 4 " .JjIIju 11) 'j*±- i>Sj} 4And Allah is All-Aware of what you do} [63:10-11] 4And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them} It p^=*1 £} upto His saying; 4that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter).} [14:44] And His saying: 22S oju ^ in oft 2 jj « ijl jft^ 4b S' jjSt^&2£ f u 4On the Day the event is finally fulfilled, those who neglected it before will say: "Verily, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back so that we might do deeds other than those deeds which we used to do?"} [7:53] And: % ilfjy >> 4And if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying): "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back, that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} [32:12] And; Cf&> Vj iji Lift ijllii it} Jj} 4If you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord..."} until His saying;

iAnd indeed they are liars. [6:27-28] « Ar iAnd you will see the wrongdoers, when they behold the torment, they will say: "Is there any way of return?"} [42:44] & ££*" Ji iThey will say: "Our Lord! You have made us to die twice, and You have given us life twice! Now we confess our sins, then is there any way to get out?"} [40:11] and the Ayah after it: u 12; S>^ £,} a \j.jz pr ii%&. <fTherein they will cry: "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not what we used to do." (Allah will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so -that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the Warner came to you. So taste you (the evil of your deeds). For the wrongdoers there is no helper."} [35:37] Allah says that they will ask to go back, when death approaches, on the Day of Resurrection, when they are gathered for judgment before the Compeller (Allah) and when they are in the agonies of the punishment of Hell, but their prayer will not be answered. Here Allah says: 4%U jihr <i\ 4No/ It is but a word that he speaks;} The word Kalla (No!) is a word that is used to rebuke, and the meaning is: "No, We will not respond to what he asks for and We will not accept it from him." jihr ilt is but a word that he speaks refers to his asking to go back so that he can do righteous deeds; this is just talk on his part, it would not be accompanied

692 Tafstr Ibn Katliir by any action. If he were to go back, he would not do righteous good deeds, he is merely lying, as Allah says: rrU Q IjjU V>j 'j) any iBut if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars [6:28], Qatadah said: "By Allah he will not wish to go back to his family and tribe, or to accumulate more of the things of this world or satisfy his desires, but he will wish that he could go back to do acts of obedience to Allah. May Allah have mercy on a man who does that which the disbeliever will wish he had done when he sees the

punishment of Hell.” Barzakh and Punishment therein “iy-*n til opr iand in front of them is Barzakh until the Day when they will be resurrected.) Abu Salih and others said that: Lo oyft iand in front of them) means before them. Mujahid said, Al- Barzakh is a barrier between this world and the Hereafter. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, uAl-Barzakh is what is between this world and the Hereafter, neither they are the people of this world, eating and drinking, nor are they with the people of the Hereafter, being rewarded or punished for their deeds.” Abu Sakhr said, “Al-Barzakh refers to the graves. They are neither in this world nor the Hereafter, and they will stay there until

the Day of Resurrection.”¹¹

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3857–3875]

r+frj iand in front of them is Barzakh). In these words is a threat to those wrongdoers at the time of death, of the punishment of Barzakh. This is similar to the Ayat iln front of them there is Hell) [45:10]. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:116.

t/Se. . *S\3j iand in front of hint will be a great torment [14:17]. 4 >j> 3^4 iuntil the Daij when they will be resurrected}. means, he will be punished continually until the Day of Resurrection, as it says in the Hadith: He will continue to be punished in itJ meaning, in the earth. \~\tV ** " // ' . />t- s \ * / > / y . kiuJJU /C-jy* Vj ^ wjL— j lipy -'i"- ' . •> ^r ; " /"i S*Y >% " w t" . // •:.*#» > > J —•*' 'Xrf* <%?' t\JSy O-ti. p-a . V* -^j>vLS pAj Jo\ <(701. 77ie/i, the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another.} 4102. Then, those whose Scales (of good deeds) are heavy, these! they are the successful.} 4103. And those whose Scales (of good deeds) are light, they are those who lose themselves, in Hell will they abide 4104. The Fire will bum their faces, and therein they xvill grin, xvith displaced lips (disfigured) .} The soundingoftheTrumpet and the weighing ofDeeds in the Scales. Allah says that when the Trumpet is blown for the Resurrection, and the people rise from their graves, //• i •V"" ^ _ ay«/ v v Vj i there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another.} meaning that lineage will be of no avail on that Day, and a father will not ask about his son or care about him. Allah says: [il Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :183

and been saved from an evil from which there is no escape.” \$And those whose Scales are light,} means, their evil deeds outweigh their good deeds. 4*4—•* iEL_i Cri' it they are those who lose themselves,} means, they are doomed and have ended up with the worst deal. Allah says: ^4*- j,} 4in Hell will they abide.} meaning, they will stay there forever and will never leave. 4'M PJJ, £&} 4The Fire will bum theirfaces,} This is like the Ayah: 4tt*&& 4andfire zoill cover tleirfaces} [14:50]. and: 0* -A3 f+^yri u* y *£-?- i O& 'pLu \$} 4If only those who disbelieved knew (the time) rohen they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, norfrom their backs} [21:39]. 4and therein they will grin, zvith displaced lips.} *Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, “Frowning.” >3* 4j y® V p r liji ijxx. jli LfU (fyt 4105. "Were not My Ayat recited to you, and then you used to deny them?"} 4106. They will say : “Our Lord! Our wretchedness overcame us, and we were (an) erring people.”} At-Tabari 19:74.

4109. Verily, there was a party ofMy servants ivho used to say: "Our Lord! We believe, so forgive us and have mercy on us, for You are the Best of all who show mercy!"} 4110. But you took them for a

laughing stock, so much so that they made you forget My remembrance while you used to laugh at them!} 4111. Verily, I have rewarded them this Day for their patience; they are indeed the ones that are successful.} Allah's Response and Rejection of the Disbelievers This is the response of Allah to the disbelievers when they ask Him to bring them out of the Fire and send them back to this world. He will say: iRemain you in it with ignominy!} meaning, abide therein, humiliated, despised and scorned. 4And speak you not to Me!} means, 'do not ask for this again, for I will not respond to you. Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas concerning this Ayah, 4oJ&>t& i£ii> iRemain you in it zuith ignominy! And speak you not to Me!} "These are the words of Ar-Rahman when silencing them." [11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, "The people of Hell will call on Malik for forty years, and he will not answer them. Then he will respond and tell them that they are to abide therein. By Allah, their cries will mean nothing to Malik or to the Lord of Malik. Then they will call on their Lord and will say, % a jj Q. aji % SJ4 & %} 4 iVVi' iOur Lord! Our wretchedness overcame us, and we were (an) erring people. Our Lord! Bring us out of this. If ever we return 111 At-Tabari 19:79.

(to evil), theii indeed we shall be wrongdoers.} [23:106-107] Allah will not answer them for a time span equivalent to twice the duration of this world. Then He will reply: iRemain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!} By Allah, the people will not utter a single word after that, and they will merely be in the Fire of Hell, sighing in a high and low tone. Their voices are likened to those of donkeys, which start in a high tone and end in a low tone."111 Then Allah will remind them of their sins in this world and how they used to make fun of His believing servants and close friends: 4s js h & <J*&: oi £[] i >> iVerily, there was a party of My servants who used to say: "Our Lord! We believe, so forgive us and have mercy on us, for You are the Best of all who show mercy!" But you took them for a laughing stock,} meaning, "you made fun of them for calling on Me and praying to Me,' iso much so that they made you forget My remembrance} means, your hatred for them made you forget what I would do to you. ^J%} iwhile you used to laugh at them!} means, at their deeds and worship. This is like the Ayah: (*-p ll/-* (^yjl \j% b\} iVerily, those who committed crimes used to laugh at those who believed. And, whenever they passed by them, used to wink one to another.} [83:29-30] m Az-Zuhd by HannSd bin Al-Sirri 1:158.

meaning, they used to slander them in mockery. Then Allah tells us how He will reward His friends and righteous servants, and says: 4'JA-' Lj fjf 4 Verily, I have rewarded them this Day for their patience meaning, 'for the harm and mockery that you inflicted on them, 1' > it * ithey are indeed the ones that are successful.} I have caused them to attain the victory of joy, safety, Paradise and salvation from the Fire.' tjfaLaN .j f O' (j f (JIS px, &£ p&. <3 ^ p> i *j* i <i& 4 u'j-*)' 4y j* ^1 csl*)* £>' Jic* *} Ii4i 4222. He rei// say: "What number of years did you stay on earth?"} 4223. They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account."} 4224. He toill say: "You stayed not but a little, if you Iwd only blown!"} 4225. "Did you think that We had created you in play, and that you would not be brought back to Us?"} 4226. So Exalted be Allah, the True King: None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of Al-'Arsh Al-Karhn!} Allah tells them how much they wasted in their short lives in this world by failing to obey Allah and worship Him Alone. If they had been patient during their short stay in this world, they would have attained victory just like His pious close friends. 4 >Y'.S^_ ; JXA Jfjii j X} S^} 4He will say: "What number of years did you stay on earth?"} means, how long did you stay in this world? . J r y Uj) LtJ

iThey loill say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account.' meaning, those who keep the records. &He will say: "You stayed not but a little..." } meaning, it was only a short time, no matter how you look at it. p)} 4*/ you had only known!} means, you would not have preferred the transient to the eternal, and treated yourself in this bad way, and earned the wrath of Allah in this short period. If you had patiently obeyed Allah and worshipped Him as the believers did, you would have attained victoryjust as they did. Allah did not create His Servants in vain iDid you think that We had created you in play,} means, 'did you think that you were created in vain, with no purpose, with nothing required ofyou and no wisdom on Our part?' Or it was said that "in play" meant to play and amuse yourselves, like the animals were created, who have no reward or punishment. But you were created to worship Allah and carry out His commands. V U1 pj} iand that you would not be brought back to Us?} means, that you would not be brought back to the Hereafter. This is like the Ayah: 4Does man think that he will be left neglected?} [75:36) iSo Exalted be Allah, the True King.} means, s. : tified be He above the idea that he should create anything in vain, for He is the True King Who is far above doing such a thing. o;2 V}4 V>

meaning, they will not be successful with Him on the Day of Resurrection; they will not prosper or be saved. iAtid say : "My Lord! Forgive and have mercy, for You are the best of those who shoiv mercy/"\$> Here Allah is teaching us to recite this supplication, for forgiveness, in a general sense, means wiping away sins and concealing them from people, and mercy means guiding a person and helping him to say and do good things. This is the end of Volume Six. Volume Seven begins with Surat An-Nur.

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TAFSIR (ABRIDGED) (Surat An-Nur to Surat Al-Ahzab, Verse 50)

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ^ Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger 3g are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against

what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - 'Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - ('Atiyah) Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn 'Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and [or] some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ. - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet ﷺ

2S. but they report from companions of the Prophet while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-'Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, 'Ata' (bin Abi Rabah), 'Ata' Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Ash-Shahbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet ﷺ, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki', Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn 'Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

Surah 24: An-Nur

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3887–3937]

The Tafsir of Surat An-Nur (Chapter - 24) Which was Revealed in Al-Madinah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. [^] \-) lEj jJ> \$ f>jE» jft) ’<\$ •'ix / // <»/• jy-i* **!} |j>yi ^ j. }*' i«i iijli Ufj'-i* -V^i> ro <0)V- i_yi. »byEjuujlj^L^l ^vi*1.A^aj^o) 1oyi/i/jljj^ y y ^ V"iV -> ..<• ><' * " y y *1' lAJ » •Alj-iqjbjyC d.)Vjd-Jd-OCI^J^Pjj\ajb jy&'<&\ viB'iA"0^ ^)J^J //M/ /^ -V /•'•JiO / /V Jbj^0 £)1 4_1— 41. A Surah which We have sent down and which We have enjoined (Faradnahn), and in it We have revealed manifest Ayat, that you may remember.) 42. The Zaniyah and the Zdni, flog each of them with a hundred stripes. Let not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah, if you believe in Allah and the Last Day. And let a party of the believers witness their punishment.)

18 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Importance of Surat An-Nur ^A Surah which We have sent down} Here Allah is pointing out the high esteem in which He holds this Surah, which is not to say that other Surahs are not important. iand which We have enjoined,} Mujahid and Qatadah said, “This means: We have explained what is lawful and unlawful, commands and prohibitions, and the prescribed punishments.” Al-Bukhari said, “Those who read it: Faradnahn, say that it means: “We have enjoined them upon you and those who come after you.”*2 iand in it We have revealed manifest Ayat,} means, clearly explained, #a> ithat you may remember. The Explanation of the Prescribed Punishment for Zina (Illicit Sex) Then Allah says: iiji~ Jij C& (>4^5 <±f}\) iThe Zdniyah and the Zdni, flog each of them with a hundred stripes.} This honorable Ayah contains the ruling on the law of retaliation for the person who commits illegal sex, and details of the punishment. Such a person will either be unmarried, meaning that he has never been married, or he will be married, meaning that he has had intercourse within the bounds of a lawful marriage, and he is free, adult and of sound mind. As for the virgin who is unwedded, the prescribed *** At-Tabari 19 :89, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :124 Fath Al-Bari 8 :301

punishment is one hundred stripes, as stated in this Ayah. In addition to this he is to be banished from his homeland for one year, as was recorded in the Two Sahih from Abu Hurayrah and Zayd bin Khalid Al-Juhani in the Hadith about the two bedouins who came to the Messenger of Allah jg. One of them said, “O Messenger of Allah, this son of mine was employed by this man, and committed Zina with his wife. I paid a ransom with him on behalf of my son one hundred sheep and a slave-girl, but when I asked the people of knowledge, they said that my son should be given one hundred stripes and banished for a year, and that this man’s wife should be stoned to death.” The Messenger of Allah jg said: iwJlIp j siJjJl 4)1 L£L> ! o-Uj a |y\ ^J\ - jiXit ja ^ jU jU t JJa «Bi/ the One in Whose Hand is my soul, I will judge between you both according to the Book of Allah. Take back the slave- girl and sheep, and your

son is to be given one hundred stripes and banished for one year. O Unays - he said to a man from the tribe of Aslam - go to this man's wife, and if she confesses, then stone her to death. Unays went to her and she confessed, so he stoned her to death.* 11 This indicates that if the person who is guilty of illegal sex is a virgin and unmarried, he should be banished in addition to being given one hundred stripes. But if married, meaning he has had intercourse within the bounds of lawful marriage, and he is free, adult and of sound mind, then he should be stoned to death. Imam Malik recorded that 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, stood up and praised and glorified Allah, then he said; "O people! Allah sent Muhammad with the truth, and revealed to him the Book. One of the things that was revealed to him was the Ayah of stoning to death, which we have recited and 111 Fath Al-Bari 5 :355 , Muslim 3 :1324

20 Tafsir Ibn Kathir understood. The Messenger of Allah ^ carried out the punishment of stoning and after him we did so, but I am afraid that as time goes by, some will say that they did not find the Ayah of stoning in the Book of Allah, and they will go astray because they abandoned one of the obligations revealed by Allah. Stoning is something that is prescribed in the Book of Allah for the person - man or woman - who commits illegal sex, if he or she is married, if decisive evidence is produced, or if pregnancy results from that, or if they confess to it."111 It was also recorded in the Two Sahls in the lengthy Hadith of Malik, from which we have quoted briefly only the portion that is relevant to the current discussion.*2 Do not feel pity for Them when carrying out the Prescribed Punishment 4? m j w •&> 4Let not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah,} Meaning, with a ruling prescribed by Allah. So the meaning of the Ayah is: "Do not feel too sorry for them where the laws of Allah are established." This does not mean that we should not naturally feel pity when carrying out the punishment. What is prohibited here is the kind of pity that may make the judge ignore the punishment altogether. This is what is not permitted for the judge. Mujahid said, 4^ Hi j ii'jw ij} iLet not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah,} "If the matter is taken to the ruling authority, the punishment has to be carried out and cannot be stopped." This was also narrated from Said bin Jubayr and 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah.'3 * It was recorded in a Hadith: 111 Mu'atta'2 :823 ' Path Al-B&ri 13:148, Muslim 3:1317. 131 Al-Baghawi 3:321.

«Compromise with the matter of prescribed punishment mutually sorting it out among yourselves, for once a matter where the prescribed punishment is required reaches me, I am obliged to carry it out.*111 Allah's saying: if you believe in Allah and the Last Day.} means, then do that, carry out the punishments on those who commit illegal sex, and strike them hard without causing any wound, so that he and others like him will be deterred by the terror of that. In Al-Musnad, it was recorded that one of the Companions said, "O Messenger of Allah, when I slaughter a sheep I feel pity for it." He said, •El iuiJ ilJj' »Yom be rewarded for that.^ Carry out the Prescribed Punishment in Public iAnd let a party of the believers witness their punishment.} This is more humiliating for the people who are guilty of illegal sex, if they are flogged in front of the people. This is because it is more effective as a deterrent and it conveys the sense of scandal and rebuke. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, iAnd let a party of the believers witness their punishment.} "Publicly." £ S& ^ } oi *1 v 3^5 j i# -V) gc v Jf} i3 . The Zani marries not but a Zaniyah or a Mushrikah ; and the Zaniyah, none marries her except a Zani or a Mushrik. Abu D&wud 4 :540. Ahmad 5 :34. The wording varies slightly.

Such a thing is forbidden to the believers. Here Allah tells us that the Zani (male who is guilty of illegal sex) does not have intercourse except with a Zaniyah (female who is guilty of illegal sex) or a Mushrikah (female idolator), meaning that no one would go along with him in this action except a sinful woman who is also guilty of Zina, or a Mushrikah who does not think it is unlawful. By the same token, *1 V i and the Zaniyah, none marries her except a Zani > a sinful man who is guilty of fornication, ior a Mushrik} (a man) who does not think it is unlawful. Je Jij'i ff-j} {Such a thing is forbidden to the believers.} meaning, indulging in this, or marrying prostitutes, or marrying chaste women to immoral men. Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said: "Allah forbade the believers from marrying prostitutes."11

* This Ayah is like the Ayah (about marrying slave-girls): {they should be chaste, not committing illegal sex, nor taking boyfriends.} [4:25] And His saying: Vj ji. {desiring chastity not committing illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as girlfriends [5:5]. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, said that a man among the believers asked the Messenger of Allah sg for permission (to marry) a woman knowm as Umm Mahzul, who used to commit adultery, and who had stated the condition that she should spend on him. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 : 127

So he asked the Messenger of Allah jgg for permission, or he mentioned the matter to him. The Messenger of Allah recited to him: £M v XM 35 'C& vj& v 477te Zani marries not but a Zdniyah or a Mushrikah; and the Zaniyah, none marries her except Zani or a Mushrik. Such a thing is forbidden to the believers.} [24:3] Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah ag said, «A Zani who has been flogged should not marry anyone except someone who is like him. A similar report was recorded by Abu Dawud in his Sunan. * A A A 'Jjjuji-Llj l pjl <4. And those who accuse chaste women, and produce notfour witnesses, flog them with eighty stripes, and reject their testimonyforever. They indeed are the rebellious.} 45. Except those wfw repent thereafter and do righteous deeds; (for such) verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Prescribed Punishment for slandering Chaste Women This Ayah states the prescribed punishment for making false accusations against chaste women, i.e., those who are free, adult and chaste. If the person who is falsely accused is a mam, the same punishment of flogging also applies. If the accuser produces evidence that what he is saying is true, then the punishment does not apply. Allah said: // i t I «" ' ty //*/ <" * Jp'-'A ^ i" 4and produce not four witnesses, flog them with eighty stripes, 1*1 Abu Dawud 2 :543.

and reject their testimony forever. They indeed are the rebellions. If the accuser cannot prove that what he is saying is true, then three rulings apply to him: (firstly) that he should be flogged with eighty stripes, (secondly) that his testimony should be rejected forever, and (thirdly) that he should be labelled as a rebellious who is not of good character, whether in the sight of Allah or of mankind. Explaining the Repentance of the One Who makes a False Accusation Then Allah says: 1 JJ**- Jli'i Jou [jt jj&\ "jl^ iExcept those who repent thereafter and do righteous deeds; (for such) verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. This exception refers to the second and third rulings mentioned above. The flogging has been carried out regardless of whether he repents or persists, and after that there is no further punishment, as is agreed among the scholars. If he repents, then his testimony may be accepted, and he is no longer to be regarded as a rebellious. This was the view of Said bin Al-Musayyib - the leader of the Tabi'in^ - and also a group among the Salaf.,2) Ash-Shalsi and Ad-Dahhak said, "His testimony cannot be accepted even if he does repent, unless he himself admits that he said something false, in which case his testimony may be accepted. "3 ' And Allah knows best. /ij ijj •pf'fr' V) Jz fj fff) OyjM

offfr J ijilj ^ iff o) ff jA iSlj 3 A.C/iL\j f se 4 if& f !\$y if /C^y if Ji 46. And for those wlv accuse their wives, but have no (1 * Referring to the generation after the Companions. [21 At-Jabari 19:105. At-Tabari 19:103, 108.

witnesses except themselves, let the testimony of one of them be four testimonies by Allah that he is one of those who speak the truth.> 47. And the fifth (testimony); invoking of the curse of Allah on him if he be of those wlv tell a lie.} 48. But she shall avert the punishment from her, if she bears witness four times by Allah, tlm t he is telling a lie.} 49. And the fifth; should be that the wrath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.} 410. And had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you! And that Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance, the All-Wise.} Details of Al-LVan This Ayah offers a way out for husbands. If a husband has accused his wife but cannot come up with proof, he can swear the Li'an (the oath of condemnation) as Allah commanded. This means that he brings her before the Imam and states what he is accusing her of. The ruler then asks him to swear four times by Allah in front of four witnesses 4that he is one of those who speak the truth} in his accusation of her adultery. &£3 3LAy} 4And the fifth ; the invoking of the curse of Allah on him if he be of those wlv tell a lie.} If he says that, then she is divorced from him by the very act of this Li'an; she is forever forbidden for him and he must give her Mahr to her. The punishment for Zina should be carried out on her, and nothing can prevent the punishment except if she also swears the oath of condemnation [Li'an) and swears by Allah four times that he is one of those who lied, i.e., in what he is accusing her of; 4And the fifth; should be that the crath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.}

Allah says: i&X£ 4But she shall avert the punishment} meaning, the prescribed punishment. * s', rs-'JV ^ "z* 'Tfs ^ ^ / vj' ' f.' ~i' / *,•' <v jo 4ii\ v..ag- j> i auL ^ 'Xpi -ysS jly iif she bears witness four times by Allah, that he is telling a lie. And the fifth; should be that the wrath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.} The wrath of Allah is mentioned specially in the case of the woman, because usually a man would not go to the extent of exposing his wife and accusing her of Zina unless he is telling the truth and has good reason to do this, and she knows that what he is accusing her of is true. So in her case the fifth testimony calls for the wrath of Allah to be upon her, for the one upon whom is the wrath of Allah, is the one who knows the truth yet deviates from it. Then Allah mentions His grace and kindness to His creation in that He has prescribed for them a way out of their difficulties. Allah says: {33* jit iAtid had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you!} meaning, many of your affairs would have been too difficult for you, 4&£&} iAtid that Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance,} means, from His servants, even if that comes after they have sworn a confirmed oath. 4i^} ithe AU-Wise.} in what He prescribes and commands and forbids There are Hadiths which explain how we are to put this Ayah into effect, why it was revealed and concerning whom among the Companions it was revealed.

The Reason why the Ayah of LVan was revealed Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: "When the Ayah jt-A Vj iuif- AjwjLi~l ^ Ani 1/iose who accuse chaste women, and produce not four witnesses, flog them with eighty stripes, and reject their testimony forever [24:4] was revealed, Sa'd bin Tjbadah, may Allah be pleased with him, - the leader of the Ansar - said, Is this how it was revealed, O Messenger of Allah?' The Messenger of Allah ^ said: Jji: U ojLi-J vl >*JU u» "O Ansar, did you hear what your leader said?» They said, 'O Messenger of Allah, do not blame him, for he is a jealous man.

By Allah, he never married a woman who was not a virgin, and he never divorced a woman but none of us would dare to marry her because he is so jealous.' Sa'd said, *By Allah, O Messenger of Allah, I know that it (the Ayah) is true and is from Allah, but I am surprised. If I found some wicked man lying down with my wife, should I not disturb him until I have brought four witnesses? By Allah, he would have finished what he was doing before I could bring them!' A little while later, Hilal bin Umayyah - one of the three whose repentance had been accepted¹¹¹ - came back from his lands at night and found a man with his wife. He saw with his own eyes and heard with his own ears, but he did not disturb him until the morning. In the morning he went to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and said, 'O Messenger of Allah, I came to my wife at night and found a man with her, and I saw with my own eyes and heard with my own ears.' The Messenger of Allah did not like what he had said and got very upset. The Ansar gathered around him and said, *We were being tested by what Sa'd bin Ubadah said, and now the Messenger of Allah will punish Hilal bin Umayyah and declare his testimony before people to be unacceptable.' Hilal said: 'By Allah, I hope that U! See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat At-Tawbah (9:118).

29 Surah 24. An-Nur (6 - 10) (Part-18 to be flogged for it.' So he testified for the fifth time that the curse of Allah would be upon him if he was telling a lie. Then it was said to his wife, 'Testify four times by Allah that he is telling a lie.' And when his wife reached the fifth testimony, she was told, 'Have Taqwa of Allah, for the punishment of this world is easier than the punishment of the Hereafter, and this will mean that the punishment will be inevitable for you.' She hesitated for a while, and was about to admit her guilt, then she said: 'By Allah, I will not expose my people to shame, and she swore the fifth oath that the wrath of Allah would be upon her if she was telling the truth.' Then the Messenger of Allah separated them, and decreed that her child should not be attributed to any father, nor should the child be accused, and whoever accused her or her child, they would be subject to punishment. He also decreed that [Hilal] was not obliged to house her or feed her, because they had not been separated by divorce, nor had he died and left her a widow. He said, *«//she gives birth to a red-haired child (with skinny thighs) and thin legs, then he is Hilal's child, but if she gives birth to a curly-haired child with thick legs and plump buttocks, then this is what she is accused of.»* She subsequently gave birth to a child who was curly-haired with thick legs and plump buttocks, and the Messenger of Allah said, *«5tiwj jis3 iujS/i oWere it not for the oath that she swore, I would deal with her.»* 'Ikrimah said, "The child grew up to become the governor of Egypt, and he was given his mother's name and was not attributed to any father." Abu Dawud recorded a similar but briefer report. This Hadith has corroborating reports in the books of Sahih ^{***} Abu Dawud 2 :688

nWait until she gives birth, and if she gives birth to a child whose eyes look as if they are ringed with kohl and who has plump buttocks and thick legs, then he is the child of Shank bin Sahmd She gave birth to a child who matched this description, and the Prophet ﷺ said, *jj iiid <ii ^ u «Were it not for the Book of Allah, I would deal with her.* This version was recorded only by Al-Bukhari,' ' but the event has been narrated with additional chains of narration from Ibn 'Abbas and others.¹² ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Said bin Jubayr said: During the governorship of Ibn Az-Zubayr I was asked about the couple who engaged in Li'an, and whether they should be separated, and I did not know the answer. I got up and went to the house of Ibn Tjmar, and said, "O Abu 'Abdur-Rahman, should the couple who engaged in Li'an be separated?" He said, "Subhan Allah, the first one to ask about this was so-and-so the son of so-

and-so. He said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, what do you think of a man who sees his wife committing an immoral sin? If he speaks he will be speaking about something very serious, and if he keeps quiet he will be keeping quiet about something very serious.’ [The Prophet 55] kept quiet and did not answer him. Later on, he came to him and said, “What I asked you about is something with which I myself being tested with.’ Then Allah revealed the Ayat, Oyj. Lflty iAndfar those who accuse their wives,} until he reached: iThat the wrath ofAllah be upon her ifhe speaks the tnith .} 111 FathAl-Bari8 :303 Tuhfat Al-Ashraf5 :170 .

32 Tafslr IbtI Kathlr started with the man, who swore four times by Allah that he was one of those who speak the truth, and swore the fifth oath that the curse of Allah would be upon him if he were lying. Then he turned to the woman, who swore four times by Allah that he was lying, and swore the fifth oath that the wrath of Allah would be upon her if he was telling the truth. Then he separated them.”111 It was also recorded by An-Nasal in his Tafslr, and by Al-Bukhari and Muslim in the Two SahlhsP I 1 * Ahmad 2:19. An-NasaT in Al-Kubra 6 :414 131 Fath Al-Bari 9 :367 , Muslim 2 : 1 130 , from Ibn ‘Umar.

4 ju /J (*p; -jj_y v—^ ill. Verily, those wlxo brought forth the slander are a group among you. Consider it not a bad thing for you. Nay, it is good for you. Unto every man among them ivill be paid that ivhich he had earned of the sin, and as for him among them who had the greater share therein, his will be a great torment.) Al-Ifk (the Slander) The next ten Ayat were all revealed concerning ‘A’ishah, the mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, when the people of slander and falsehood among the hypocrites made their accusations against her and spread lies about her. Allah became jealous on her behalf and on behalf of His Prophet sg, and revealed her innocence to protect the honor of the Messenger of Allah jg. He said: j'.C- iVerily, those who brought forth the slander are a group among you.) meaning they were not one or two, but a group. Foremost among this group was ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, the leader of the hypocrites, who fabricated the lie and whispered it to others, until some of the Muslims started to believe it, and others thought it might be possible and began to talk about it. This is how matters remained for almost a month, until Qur’an was revealed. This is reported in Sahih Hadlths. Imam Ahmad recorded that Az-Zuhri said: Said bin Al- Musayyib, Urwah bin Az-Zubayr, ‘Alqamah bin Waqqas and Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah bin TJtbah bin MasUd told me about the story of ‘A’ishah, the wife of the Prophet when the people of the slander said what they said about her, and Allah declared her innocence. Each of them told something about the story, and some of them knew more details than others or had memorized more than others. I learned the stoiy from each of them, who had heard it from ‘A’ishah herself, and what one told me confirmed what the others said. They mentioned that ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, the wife of the Prophet jg, said: “When the Messenger of Allah gg

wanted to go on a journey, he would cast lots among his wives, and the one whose lot was drawn would go with him.” ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, “So he drew lots among us with regard to a campaign he was going out on, and mine was drawn, so I went out with the Messenger of Allah j§. This was after the commandment of Hijab had been revealed, so I traveled in my howdah and stayed in it when we camped. We traveled until the Messenger of Allah jg completed his campaign, then we returned. As we were approaching Al- Madinah, we paused for a while, then they announced that the

journey was to be resumed. When I heard this, I walked quickly away from the army to answer the call of nature, then I came back to my howdah. Then I put my hand to my chest and noticed that a necklace of mine that was made of onyx and cornelian had broken, so I went back and looked for it, and was delayed because of that. In the meantime, the people who used to lift my howdah onto my camel came along and put it on the camel, thinking that I was inside. In those times women were more slender and not so heavy, they only ate mouthfuls of food. So the people did not think anything of the howdah being so light when they lifted it up, as I was a young woman. They set off, and I found my necklace after the army had moved on. Then I came back to the place where we had stopped, and I saw no one to call or answer. So I went to the place where I had been, thinking that the people would miss me and come back for me. While I was sitting there, I fell asleep. Safwan bin Al-Mu'attal As-Sulami Adh-Dhakwani had rested during the night behind the army. Then he set out just before daybreak and reached the place where I was in the morning, where he saw the outline of a person sleeping. He came to me and recognized me when he saw me, as he had seen me before Hijab was made obligatory for me. When he saw me and said 'Truly, to Allah we belong, and truly, to Him we shall return,' I woke up, and covered my face with my Jilbab (outer garment). By Allah, he did not speak a word to me and I did not hear him say anything except 'Truly, to Allah we belong, and truly, to Him we shall return,' until he brought his camel and made it kneel so that I could ride upon it, then he set out leading the camel until we caught up with the army at Zuhr time.

There are people who are doomed because of what happened to me, and the one who had the greater share therein was 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salui. When we came back to Al-Madinah, I was ill for a month, and the people were talking about what the people of the slander were saying, and I knew nothing about it. What upset me when I was ill was that I did not see the kindness I used to see on the part of the Messenger of Allah When I was ill; he would just come in and say, 'How is that lady?' That is what upset me. I did not feel that there was anything wrong until I went out after I felt better, and Umm Mistah went out with me, walking towards Al-Manasi', which is where we used to go to relieve ourselves, and we would not go out for that purpose except at night. This was before we had lavatories close to our houses; our habit was similar to that of the early Arabs in that we went out into the deserts to relieve ourselves, because we considered it troublesome and harmful to have lavatories in our houses. So I went out with Umm Mistah, who was the daughter of Abu Ruhm bin Al-Muttalib bin 'Abd Manaf, and her mother was the daughter of Sakhr bin 'Amir, the paternal aunt of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq. Her son was Mistah bin Uthathah bin 'Abbad bin Al-Muttalib. When we finished what we had to do, the daughter of Abu Ruhm Umm Mistah and I came back towards my house. Umm Mistah stumbled over her apron and said, "May Mistah be ruined!" I said to her, 'What a bad thing you have said! Are you abusing a man who was present at Badr?' She said, 'Good grief, have you not heard what he said?' I said, 'What did he say?' So she told me what the people of the slander were saying, which made me even more ill. When I returned home, the Messenger of Allah came in to me and greeted me, then he said, 'How is that lady?' I said to him, 'Will you give me permission to go to my parents?' At that time I wanted to confirm the news by hearing

"Be glad O 'A'ishah, Allah has declared your innocence. » My mother said to me, 'Get up and go to him.' I said, 'By Allah, I will not go to him and I will not give praise to anyone except Allah, may He be glorified, for He is the One Who has proven my innocence.' So Allah revealed: 'Verily, those who

brought forth the slander are a group among you.}, until the ten Ayat. Allah revealed these Ayat concerning my innocence. Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, who used to spend on Mistah bin Uthathah because he was a close relative and because he was poor, said, “By Allah, I will never spend anything on him again after what he has said about ‘A’ishah.’ Then Allah revealed, ‘fit V\$ jit iAnd let not those among you who are blessed with graces and wealth swear not to give to their kinsmen .} until His saying: %% ft j 3U \$Do you not love that Allah should forgive you? And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful [24:22]. So Abu Bakr said, ‘By Allah, certainly I love that Allah should forgive me.’ So he resumed spending on Mistah as he had spent on him before, and he said, “By Allah, I shall never stop spending on him.’ The Messenger of Allah jfe asked Zaynab bint Jahsh about my situation, and said, jioJp lit* . w "O Zaynab, what do you know and xwhat have you seen?» She said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, may Allah protect my hearing and my sight. By Allah, I know nothing but good.’ She is the one who used to compete with me among the wives of the Prophet 2S, but Allah protected her (from telling lies) because of her piety. But her sister Hamnah bint Jahsh kept on

fighting on her behalf, so she was doomed along with those who were doomed.” Ibn Shihab said, “This is as much as we know about this group of people.”¹¹ It was also by Al-Bukhari and Muslim in their Sahihs from the Hadith of Az-Zuhri,¹²¹ and by Ibn Ishaq also from Az-Zuhri. ¹³¹ He also said: “Yahya bin ‘Abbad bin ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr told me from his father, from ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, and ‘Abdullah bin Abi Bakr bin Muhammad bin ‘Amr bin Hazm Al- Ansari told me from ‘Amrah, from ‘A’ishah, (a report) similar to that quoted above. And Allah knows best. Allah’s saying: 4«ss\$ ifM \} 4Verily, those who brought forth the slander} means, the lies, falsehood and fabrications. iare a group} means, a gang among you. V» 4Consider it not a bad thingfor you.} O family ofAbu Bakr, 4^3£ 1& 4Nay, it is good for you.} means, in this world and the Hereafter, honorable mention in this world and raised status in the Hereafter. Allah demonstrated the esteem with which He regarded the family ofAbu Bakr when He defended ‘A’ishah the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, by revealing her innocence in the Qur’an, iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it...} [41:42). Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, entered upon her when she was dying, he said to her, “Rejoice, for you are the wife of the Messenger of Allah jg and he used to love you; ¹¹¹ Ahmad 1 :194. ¹²¹ Path Al-Bari 8 :306 , Muslim 4 :2 129 ¹³¹ Ibn Hisham 3 :309

he did not marry any virgin other than you, and your innocence was revealed from heaven.” ot ^ (44 && 4Unto every man among them will be paid that which he had earned of the sin,} means, each of those who spoke about this matter and accused the Mother of the believers ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, of any immoral action, will have a great share of punishment. i’fft Jj 4ft iand as for him among them who had the greater share therein,} It was said that this referred to the one who initiated the rumors, or that it was the one who collected rumors and spread them among the people. ft ihis will be a great torment.} means, for that. He was ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, may Allah disfigure him and curse him. vj :f:*J u£\$6£ ^ 4^0^53' p> x.g L& P *-V1 412. Why then, did not the believers, men and women, when you heard it, think good of their own people and say: "This is an obvious lie?"} 413. Why did they not produce four witnesses against him? Since they have not produced witnesses! Then with Allah, they are the liars.} Disciplining the Believers for spreading the Slander Here Allah disciplines the believers with regard to the matter of ‘A’ishah, because some of

them spread this evil talk and the slander that had been mentioned. So Allah says: 111 FathAl-Bari 8:340.

4& iWhy then, when you heard it,} meaning, the talk which accused the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, 4the believers, men and women, think good of their own people means, why did they not compare what was said to themselves - if it was not befitting for them then it was even less appropriate for the Mother of the believers, and she was more likely to be innocent. Or it was said that this was revealed about Abu Ayyub Khalid bin Zayd Al-Ansari and his wife, may Allah be pleased with them. Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar narrated, "The wife of Abu Ayyub Khalid bin Zayd Al-Ansari, Umm AyyQb, said to him, 'O Abu AyyQb, have you heard what the people are saying about 'A'ishah?' He said, Tes, and it is all lies. Would you do that, O Umm AyyUb?' She said, 'No, by Allah, I would not do that.' He said, 'And by Allah, 'A'ishah is better than you.' When the Qur'an was revealed, Allah mentioned those who spoke about the evil deed among the people of the slander, iVerily, those who broughtforth the slander are a group among you.} [24:1] This refers to Hassan and his companions who said what they said. Then Allah said. iWhy then, did not the believers, men, when you heard it, think...} means, as Abu Ayyub and his wife did."111 Allah's saying: Si '£} ithe believers, men think...} meaning, *why did they not think good, because the Mother of HI At-Tabari 19:129.

43Surah 24. An-Nur (13 - 15) (Part-18) the believers is his wife and is closer to him.' This is concerned with innermost feelings; iand say :} means, with their tongues, verbally, i"This (charge) is an obvious lie?"} means, a clear untruth told about the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her. What happened should not have been the cause of suspicion. The fact that the Mother of the believers came openly, riding on the camel of Salwan bin Al-Mu'attal at midday, with the entire army watching and the Messenger of Allah jg among them, should have made it clear that there was no cause for suspicion. If there had been anything suspicious about the matter, they would not have come openly in this manner in front of so many witnesses; they would have come secretly. On this basis, what the people of the slander said accusing the Mother of the believers was an utter lie, false speech and evil foolish talk, by which people who indulged in it lost out. Allah said: 4Why did they not produce four witnesses against him?} meaning, to prove that what they were sayingwas true. iyL p i\$} 4Since they have not produced witnesses! Then with Allah they are the liars.} Allah has ruled that they are indeed wicked liars. ih% Cif if X2 S?ji> «iif i* '£) ill ^ oJ&J 414. Had it not been for the grace ofAllah and His mercy unto you in this world and in the Hereafter, a great torment would have touched you for that whereofyou had spoken.} 425. When you were propagating it with your tongues, and uttering with your mouths that whereofyou had no knowledge,

44—— TafsJr Ibn Kathir you counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great.} The Grace ofAllah towards the People ofthe Slanderby givingThem the Opportunity to repent Allah says, UjI' (j *uf jJj iHad it not been for the grace ofAllah and His mercy unto you in this world and in the Hereafter,} This is addressed to those who were indulging in discussing the matter of A ishah, informing them that Allah has accepted their repentance in this world, and forgiven them because of their faith in the Hereafter. iwould have touched youfor that whereofyou had spoken .} with regard to the slander. Aa great torment This refers to those who had faith in Allah because of their repentance, such as Mistah, Hassan andHamnah bint Jahsh the sister ofZaynab bint Jahsh. As for the hypocrites

who indulged in the slander, such as ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Saltil and his like, they are not the ones who are referred to in this Ayah , because they did not have sufficient faith and righteous deeds to balance or cancel out what they had done. By the same token, the threats that were narrated for a specific deed are bound to be carried out, if there is no repentance or sufficient righteous deeds to balance or outweigh it. Then Allah says: AWhen you were propagating it with your tongues,} Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said, “Some of you were relating it to others,”¹¹¹ where one says, I heard this from so-and-so, and so-and-so said such and such, and some of them m At-Jabari 19:132

mentioned such and such.’ Others recited the Ayah: (“When you were inventing a lie with your tongues...”)¹¹¹ In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is recorded that ‘A’ishah recited it like that.¹¹¹ According to her, the meaning refers to lies which a person persists in telling. The first recitation is preferred and more popular, and the majority recite it that way, but the second is reported from ‘A’ishah, the Mother of the believers. iartd uttering with your mouths that whereof you had no knowledge,} means, you were speaking about something which you knew nothing about. Then Allah says: dll' X£ Jbj Li* *(if~i<y^ 4you counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great. means, ‘you said what you said about the Mother of the believers and you thought that it was a trifling and insignificant matter, but even if she was not the wife of the Prophet jg, it still would not be an insignificant matter - so how about when she is the wife of the Unlettered Prophet, the Seal of the Prophets and Leader of the Messengers 3g?’ It is a very serious matter with Allah that such a thing should be said about the wife of His Messenger! For Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, feels great fury and anger over such matters, and He would never decree such a thing for the wife of any of His Prophets. If that is the case, then how about the best of the wives of any Prophet, the wife of the best of the sons of Adam in this world and the next? Allah says: 4I1' X£ jbj Lla ^ iyou counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great.} ¹¹¹ Fath Al-Bari 8 :340

In the Two Sahihs it is reported that: (jS ^ tSyii '(p 1* fr'J 0!" frLULJI ^*^1, La iili «A man may say a word that angers Allah without realizing how far it will go, and because of that he will be thrown into Hell a distance greater than that between heaven and earths According to another report: Wc I4J jk, “And he may not pay any attention to ^P J LJ op. u£ \ p ft p 4 Q \j& J a 416. And why did you not, when you heard it, say: "It is not rightfor us to speak of this. Glory be to You (O Allah)! This is a great lie.”\$ il7. Allah forbids you from it and zooms you not to repeat the like of it forever, if you are believers> 418. And Allah makes the Ayat plain to you, and Allah is All- Knowing, All-Wise Further Discipline This is further discipline, in addition to the command to think well of people, i.e., if something unbefitting is mentioned about good people, then one should think well of them, and not feel towards them anything but good. Then if a person has any unsuitable thoughts about them, insinuated into his mind and imagination by Shaytan, he should not speak about that, for

the Prophet jg said: 3 ' (d U 141^1 cJIU- lit jpi jjUi 3>l bp Allah will excuse my Ummah for anything that occurs to their minds, so long as they do not speak about it or act upon it . m Fath Al-Bari 11 :3 14 , Muslim 4 :2290

This was reported in the Two SahihsJ Allah’s saying: i\%P j U& u£ i&S. \ 4And why did you not, when you heard it, say: “It is not rightfor us to speak of this”.} meaning, we should not talk about it or mention it to anyone. l£r }Clory be to You (O Allah)! This is a great lie.} means, gloiy be to Allah that

such a thing should be said about the wife of His Prophet and close Friend Then Allah says, 4Q ULJ jt&s J 'itpL} iAlldh forbids you from it and warns you not to repeat the like of it forever,} meaning, Allah is forbidding you and warning you from doing anything like this again in the future. Allah says, pr ^} 4if you are believers.} meaning, if you believe in Allah and His Laws, and you respect His Messenger As for those who are described as disbelievers, a different ruling applies in their case. Then Allah says, p at •£> 4And Allah makes the Ayat plain to you,} meaning, He makes clear to you the rulings of Shari'ah and His divine decrees. 4l4fo fjz.% 4and Allah is All-Knowing, AU-Wise.} means, He knows what is right for His servants and He is Wise in His Laws and decrees. y-% Git 4 £f&ip. <G/ it 4 IU. <\$ 40&& iM % 111 FathAl-Bari 11:557, Muslim 1:116, 117.

4.19. Verily, those who like that Fahishah should be circulated among those who believe, they will have a painful torment in this world and in the Hereafter. And Allah knows and you know not.} Disciplining Those Who like that Illegal Sexual Intercourse should be circulated among the Believers This is a third instance of discipline directed at those who hear evil talk, believe it to some extent, and start to spread it; they should not spread such talk or pass it on to others. Allah says: 4Verily, those who like that Faltshah should be circulated among those who believe, they will have a painful torment meaning, those who like to see evil talk about them (the believers) appear, 4Q% 4 £jj p.} it they will have a painful torment in this world} means, because of the prescribed punishment, and in the Hereafter because of the torment in Hell. 4&J& * && pi 4And Allah knows and you know not.} means, return the matter to Him and you will be guided. Imam Ahmad recorded from Thawban that the Prophet said: vJlJ* {j* I Vj Nj 4ll Slip IjSjJ «Do not annoy the servants of Allah, nor abuse them, nor seek their hidden shortcomings. Whoever seeks out the faults of his Muslim brother, Allah will expose his faults and degrade him, even if he is hiding in his house» Ahmad 5 :279

50 Tafsir Ibn Kathir kindness towards His servants and Merciful towards them. He accepts the repentance of those who repent to Him from this sin, and purifies those among them who are purified by the prescribed punishment carried out on them. Then Allah says: v iA*' <0 you who believe! Follow not the Khutuwa of Shaytan.} meaning, his ways and paths and what he commands. iAnd whosoever follows the footsteps of Shaytan, then, verily, he commands immorality and the evil deeds.} This is a warning given in the most concise and eloquent manner. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that ithe Khutuwa of Shaytan} means his deeds.111 akrimah said that it means his evil whispers. Qatadah said: "Every sin is one of the footsteps of Shaytan."121 Abu Mijlaz said: "Vowing to commit sin is one of the footsteps of Shaytan."*31 Then Allah says: iAnd had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you, not one of you would ever have been pure from sins.} meaning, if He did not help whomever He wills to repent and come back to Him and be purified from Shirk, evil and sin, and whatever bad characteristics each person has according to his nature, no one would ever attain purity and goodness. il&i & >4 iu' <£[]} iBut Allah purifies whom He wills} means, among His creation, and He sends astray whomever He wills, leaving him to be doomed in his misguidance and sin. && At-Tabari 3 :301 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 1 :404. AMabari 3:301.

iand Allah is All-Hearer, means, He hears what His servants say, iAll-Knower of who deserves to be guided and who deserves to be misguided. 4ji' 4 [y]i <J 4,'n'^oy jyi- ill! _/iij o 1 VI [ynjuaJj iyjtJj <22 . And /ef nof f/iouse among you who are blessed with graces and wealth swear not to give to their

kinsmen, the poor, and those who left their homes for Allah's cause. Let them pardon and forgive. Do you not love that Allah should forgive you? And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Urging Those Who have been blessed with Wealth to give and to be tolerant Allah says, > iAnd let not swear> meaning, make an oath, jjaat those among you who are blessed with graces } means, those who have the means to give charity and do good, iand wealth} means, good fortune. J-v* 4 Ojt)l jy}> ito give to their kinsmen, the poor, and those who left their homes for Allah's cause.} means, do not swear that you will not uphold the ties of kinship with your relatives who are needy or who migrated for the sake of Allah, which is the ultimate act of kindness in the area of upholding kinship ties. Allah says, 4'b^j iLet them pardon and forgive.} past insults and bad treatment. This is part of the patience, generosity and kindness of Allah

towards His creation, despite the fact that they wrong themselves. This Ayah was revealed concerning As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, when he swore that he would not help Mistah bin Uthathah after he said what he said about 'A'ishah, as we have already seen in the Hadith. When Allah revealed the innocence of the Mother of the believers, 'A'ishah, and the believers were happy and content with the outcome of this incident, and those believers who had talked about the matter repented, and the prescribed punishment had been carried out upon those on whom it was carried out, then Allah started to soften the heart of As-Siddiq towards his relative Mistah bin Uthathah. Mistah was the cousin of As-Siddiq, the son of his maternal aunt, and he was a poor man with no wealth except whatever Abu Bakr spent on him. He was one of those who had migrated for the sake of Allah. He had invented the lies and the slander, but then Allah accepted his repentance from that and the prescribed punishment was carried out on him. As-Siddiq was known for his generosity and he did favors to his relatives and strangers alike. When this Ayah was revealed: Slit 'jfa j 0^4 \$Do you not love that Allah should forgive you?}, which shows that the reward fits the action, and that "if you forgive others, you will be forgiven," then As-Siddiq said, "Of course, by Allah, we love - O our Lord - that You should forgive us." Then he resumed his spending on Mistah and said, "By Allah I will never stop spending on him." This was to counteract what he had said previously, "By Allah I will never spend on him." This proves that he deserved to be called As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him and his daughter. & bh% Q% 4 \f4 sit ^ rri* % (+0J V* (k i23. Verily, those who accuse chaste believing women, who never even think of anything touching their chastity and are good believers - are cursed in this life and in the Hereafter, and

53 Surah 24. Ati-Nur (23 - 25) (Part-18) for them will be a great torment.) 424. On the Day when their tongues, their hands, and their legs will bear witness against them as to what they used to do. 425. On that Day Allah will pay them the recompense of their deeds in full, and they will know that Allah, He is the Manifest Truth.) A Threat to Those who accuse Chaste Women, Who never even think of anything touching their Chastity and are Good Believers This is a warning and threat from Allah to those who accuse chaste women, who never even think of anything effecting their chastity since they are good believers. The Mothers of the believers are more entitled to be included in this category than any other chaste woman, especially the one who was the reason for this Ayah being revealed: 'A'ishah bint As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with them both. All of the scholars agree that whoever slanders her or makes accusations against her after what has been said in this Ayah, is a disbeliever, because of his being obstinate with the Qur'an. The same ruling applies to all of the Mothers of the believers. 4bb%Q* a 4are cursed in this life and in the Hereafter,) This is like the Ayah: 4&--U Sf AH 0\$ 4Verily, those who

annoy Allah and His Messenger,) [33:57] ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “This is about ‘A’ishah, and whoever does anything similar nowadays to Muslim women, the same applies to him, but ‘A’ishah is the one who is primarily referred to here.” Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah g? said: m At-Tabari 19:139.

jlala J^dj 5^ c-dJ j£L*i U>vij IjJu : Jjjj f ^Jl jLj cL ^Because of the way a person will dispute with his Lord. He will say, “O Lord, did you not protect me from doing wrong?” Allah will say, "Of course," The person will say, "I will not accept for anyone to give testimony concerning me except myself." Allah will say, "You are sufficient as a witness against yourself." Then a seal will be put upon his mouth and it will be said to his faculties, "Speak." So they will speak about his deeds . Then he will be permitted to speak, and he will say, "Away with you! I was only speaking in your defence/”» This was recorded by Muslim and An-Nasab 111 >>’ i , v) iOn that Day Allah will pay Dinahum,} Ibn ‘Abbas said, iDinahum} “Meaning ‘their account.’ Every time Dinahum appears in the Qur’an it means *their account.’” This was also the view of other scholars.¹²¹ i’jdi &2& 3a&fr iand they will know that Allah, He is the Manifest Truth.} means, His promise, His threat and His reckoning are all just and there is no unfairness in them. dX£\$ o’i.LU jfy. cJ+JbiJ) } j. v ’ t’.:i ?*’-’ I- / ’ p** - ^i>*’- 426. Bad statements are for bad people and bad people for bad statements. Good statements are for good people and good people for good statements: such are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say; for them is forgiveness, and honored provision.} 111 Muslim 2969 121 At-Jabari 19:141.

The Goodness of ‘A’ishah because She is married to the best of Mankind Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Evil words are for evil men, and evil men are for evil words; good words are for good men and good men are for good words. This was revealed concerning ‘A’ishah and the people of the slander.” This was also narrated from Mujahid, ‘Ata’, Said bin Jubayr, Ash-Sha‘ai, Al-Hasan bin Abu Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Habib bin Abi Thabit and Ad-Dahhak, and it was also the view favored by Ibn Jarir.*2 * He interpreted it to mean that evil speech is more suited to evil people, and good speech is more suited to good people. What the hypocrites attributed to Aishah was more suited to them, and she was most suited to innocence and having nothing to do with them. Allah said: 44>*AA tUyj isuch (good people) are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say;} Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “Evil women are for evil men and evil men are for evil women, and good women are for good men and good men are for good women.”*3 This also necessarily refers back to what they said, i.e., Allah would not have made ‘A’ishah the wife of His Messenger jg unless she had been good, because he is the best of the best of mankind. If she had been evil, she would not have been a suitable partner either according to His Laws or His decree. Allah said: 4)jZA a isuch are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say;} meaning, they are remote from what the people of slander and enmity say. iW& ifor them is forgiveness,} means, because of the lies that were told about them, At-Tabari 19 :142 , Ad-Durr Al-ManthOr6:167. At-Tabari 19:143, 144. At-Tabari 19:144.

- 29) (Part-18) 57 j&>m ror mm» b* s - / ztz <* *> ^V’-Jz x f*. >’-••«* J£* I*’ Ajys— f~Lx>- \$ ^ lf-3 Jij ^r*j i)yC^aA*f/^~ii’o)^cSS^ lilJ’i / •>•.’?’-’ * y- ’ \:.’y ’- ,’*V ’ : *r ^)04^ . <lz4^>V S^A)’Ss^P-’l^j <Sti>-^ J*1^4-3^!JJ<^zJft<jJLUyJLJli \$<<£££&#^kSlzJ^Ui 4andhonoredprovision. ^ meaning, with Allah in the Gardens of Delight. This implies a promise that she will be the wife of the Messenger of Allah % in Paradise. »jU.JL5 V !*.l# ^ V&? j i’ *V ->* , *>•> v _^o»- ,i wj-i t/ // » J */< . Ill/ »z L+i>i

jjt b-i-b b-jU_3 j&fr £5 £ J&> i>-*^f J oj A/z _//>> i/ .Z *> •' Zi / . ^ lj^-1 j* !>»*y' j-j i^> <5j£s C 56 p & J ££ £& S\$ «>" ... --'s.' ••'. .*» : tf *; <jZ* 4jyw« _/££• Uj-i 4^" llj b jizu 4ib 427. O t/OH 10/10 believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them; that is better for you, in order that you may remember> 428. And if you find no one therein, still enter not until permission has been given . And if you are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer far you . And Allah is All-Knoiver of what you do.} 429. There is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited, you have any interest in them. And Allah has knowledge of what you reveal and what you conceal.}

58 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Seeking Permission and the Etiquette of entering Houses This is the Islamic etiquette. Allah taught these manners (of seeking permission) to His believing servants and commanded them not to enter houses other than their own until they had asked permission, i.e., to ask for permission before entering and to give the greeting of Salam after asking. One should seek permission three times, and if permission is given, (he may enter), otherwise he should go away. It was reported in the Sahih that when Abu Musa asked TJmar three times for permission to enter and he did not give him permission, he went away. Then 'Umar said, "Did I not hear the voice of 'Abdullah bin Qays asking for permission to enter? Let him come in." So they looked for him, but found that he had gone. When he came later on, 'Umar said, "Why did you go away?" He said, "I asked for permission to enter three times, but permission was not given to me, and I heard the Prophet jg say, jmai.l» <j j |fii jtil Ijñ "If any one of you asks for permission three times and it is not given, then let him go awayj" 'Umar said, "You should certainly bring me evidence for this or I shall beat you!" So he went to a group of the Ansar and told them what *Umar said. They said, "No one will give testimony for you but the youngest of us." So Abu Said Al-Khudri went with him and told TJmar about that. TJmar said, "What kept me from learning that was my being busy in the marketplace."1 ' 1 Imam Ahmad recorded a narration stating that Anas or someone else said that the Messenger of Allah jg asked for permission to enter upon Sa'd bin TJbadah. He said: ««il kj-'/j Side- ^As-Salamit 'Alayka wa RahmatuIIah» Sa'd ssiid, "Wa 'Alaykas-Salam Wa RahmatuUdh," but the Prophet sg did not hear the returned greeting until he had m At-Tabari 19:144.

given the greeting three times and Sa'd had returned the greeting three times, but he did not let him hear him [i.e., Sa'd responded in a low voice]. So the Prophet jg went back, and Sa'd followed him and said, "O Messenger of Allah, may my father and mother be ransomed for you! You did not give any greeting but I responded to you, but I did not let you hear me. I wanted to get more of your Salams and blessings." Then he admitted him to his house and offered him some raisins. The Prophet jg ate, and when he finished, he said, jUuu ±L*j May the righteous eat your food, may the angels send blessings upon you and may those who are fasting break their fast with you.d' It should also be known that the one who is seeking permission to enter should not stand directly in front of the door; he should have the door on his right or left, because of the Hadith recorded by Abu Dawud from 'Abdullah bin Busr, who said, "When the Messenger of Allah jg came to someone's door, he would never stand directly in front of it, but to the right or left, and he would say, fSLiH vAs-Salamu 'Alaykum, As-Salamu 'AlaykumJ That was because at that time the houses had no covers or curtains over their doorways." This report was recorded by Abu Dawud only.'21 In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah Sg said: jXle- jIS U olLb ciJLio jij JJu ^Il>l Wyt\ ji "ft «/" a person looks into your house without your

permission, and you throw a stone at him and it puts his eye out, there will be no blame on you. s'3 ' Ahmad 3 :138. * Abu Dawud 5 :374 131 Fath Al-Bari 12 :253 , Muslim 3 :1699

The Group recorded that Jabir said, "I came to the Prophet jg with something that was owed by my father and knocked at the door. He said, «?ii j;» uWho is that?» I said, "I am!" He said, •til ui» «/? I?o as ifhe disliked it."111 He did not like it because this word tells you nothing about who is saying it, unless he clearly states his name or the name by which he is known, (nickname) otherwise everyone could call himself "Me", and it does not fulfill the purpose of asking permission to enter, which is to put people at their ease, as commanded in the Ayah. Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, "Putting people at ease means seeking permission to enter." This was also the view of others.121 Imam Ahmad recorded from Kaladah bin Al-Hanbal that at the time of the Conquest (of Makkah), Safwan bin Umayyah sent him with milk, a small gazelle, and small cucumbers when the Prophet jg was at the top of the valley. He said, "I entered upon the Prophet sg and I did not give the greeting of Salam nor ask for permission to enter. The Prophet sg said, (*Ul : jii «Go back and say: "As-Saldu 'Alaykum, may I enter?"» This was after Safwan had become Muslim."13, This was also recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Gharib."141 Ibn Jurayj said that he heard 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah narrating that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "There are three Ayat whose rulings people neglect. Allah says, 111 FathAl-B&ri 11:37, Muslim 3 :1296, Abu Dawud 5:374, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi7 :49 1 , An-NasAl in Al-Kubni 6 :90 , Ibn Majah 2 : 1222 At-Tabari 19:146. 131 Ahmad 3:414. 141 Abu Dawud 5 :368 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :490 , An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :87

& i* oi iVerily, the most honorable of you with Allah is the one who has the most Taqwa (49:13], But (now) they say that the most honorable of them with Allah is the one who has the biggest house. As for seeking permission, the people have forgotten all about it." I said, "Should I seek permission to enter upon my orphan sisters who are living with me in one house?" He said, "Yes." I asked him to make allowances for me but he refused and said, "Do you want to see them naked?" I said, "No." He said, "Then ask for permission to enter." I asked him again and he said, "Do you want to obey Allah?" I said, "Yes." He said, "Then ask for permission." Ibn Jurayj said, "Ibn Tawus told me that his father said, There are no women whom I hate to see naked more than those who are my Mahrams.' He was very strict on this point." Ibn Jurayj narrated that Az-Zuhri said, "I heard Huzayl bin Shurahbll Al-Awdi Al-A'ma (say that) he heard Ibn Mas*ud say, You have to seek permission to enter upon your mothers.'" Ibn Jurayj said, "I said to 'Ata': Does a man have to seek permission to enter upon his wife?' He said, 'No, it can be understood that this is not obligatory, but it is better for him to let her know that he is coming in so as not to startle her, because she may be in a state where she does not want him to see her.'" Abu JaTar bin Jarir narrated from the nephew of Zaynab - the wife of 'Abdullah bin Mas*Qd - that Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "When 'Abdullah came back from some errand and reached the door, he would clear his throat and spit, because he did not want to come suddenly and find us in a state he disliked. Its chain of narration is Sahdi. & iApj ^£ i5£ V !£C #£> 40 you who believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them Muqatil bin Hayyan said: "During the Jahiliyyah, when a man (i) At-Tabari 19:148. This reference applies to the previous four narrations , as well

met his friend, he would not greet him with Salam; rather he would say “Huyyita Sabahan” or “Huyyita Masa’an” [equivalent to “Good morning” or “Good evening”]. This was the greeting among the people at that time. They did not seek permission to enter one another’s houses; a man might walk straight in and say, “I have come in,” and so on. This was difficult for a man to bear, as he might be with his wife. So Allah changed all that by enjoining covering and chastity, making it pure and free of any sin or impropriety. So Allah said: *ipp& iAAj iA^^ v p: jS ife}* 40 you who believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them...^{*TM} What Muqatil said is good. Allah said: *ip£ pi}* it is better for you,} meaning, seeking permission to enter in is better for you because it is better for both parties, the one who is seeking permission to enter and the people inside the house. *pi}* in order that you may remember.} *iAnd ifyou find no one therein, still enter not until permission has been given .}* This has to do with the way in which one deals with other people’s property without their permission. If he wants to, he can give permission, and if he wants to he can refrain from giving permission. 10A 'P Jj if)} *iAnd if you are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer for you.}* m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:176.

63Surah 24. An-Niir (27 - 29) (Part-18) means, if you are turned away at the door, before or after permission has been given, *ip&\$ igo back, for it is purerfor you.}* means, going back is purer and better for you. *i%4&ZC iAnd Allah is All-Knower ofwhat you do.}* Qatadah said that one of the emigrants said: “All my life I tried to follow this Ayah, but if I asked for permission to enter upon one ofmy brothers and he asked me to go back, I could not do so happily, although Allah says, *iAnd if you are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer for you. And Allah is All-Knower ofwhat you do.}*’ [1] *p\$P Si# iAnd ifyou are asked to go back, go back....}* Said bin Jubayr said, “This means, do not stand at people’s doors.” *ijipS pZ JpZ -PP P}* *iThere is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited,}* This Ayah is more specific than the one that comes before it, because it states that it is permissible to enter houses where there is nobody, if one has a reason for doing so, such as houses that are prepared for guests - if he has been given permission once, then this is sufficient. Ibn Jurayj said, “Ibn ‘Abbas said: *iEnter not houses other than your own,}* then this was abrogated and an exception was made, and Allah said: *i%j £2£ gpZ£ |3£ jjLZ 01pZ PpJ# m At-Tabari 19:150.*

iThere is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited, (when) you have any interest in them .\$ This was also narrated from ‘Ikrimah¹¹¹ and Al-Hasan Al- Basri. C \$ £ .fif*^ >' *" 430. Tell the believing men to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts . That is purerfor them . Verily, Allah is All-Aware ofwhat they do.\$> TheCommand to lower the Gaze This is a command from Allah to His believing servants, to lower their gaze from looking at things that have been prohibited for them. They should look only at what is permissible for them to look at, and lower their gaze from forbidden things. If it so happens that a person’s gaze unintentionally falls upon something forbidden, he should quickly look away. Muslim recorded in his Sahih that Jarir bin ‘Abdullah Al-Bajali, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I asked the Prophet 0 about the sudden glance, and he commanded me to turn my gaze away.”^{*21} In the Sahih it is narrated that Abu Said said that the Messenger of Allah 0, said: “Beware of sitting in the streets . They said, “O Messenger of Allah, we have no alternative but to sit in the streets to converse with one another.” The Messenger ofAllah0 said: \ ^:!ji jls «Ifyou insist, then give the street its rights . They asked, “What are the rights of the street, O Messenger ofAllah?” He said, At-Jabari 19:153. t2 * Muslim 3 :1699.

« Jc- ik-ij' JUL ^Wlj Sjj .LiSj i j-ijl slower your gaze, return the greeting of Saldm, enjoin what is good and forbid what is evil V 1 ' Abu Al-Qasim Al-Baghawi recorded that Abu Umamah said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: lip "fi •Zjli- lij I^JUSI" \ yB&} Ij. jff'j i v- -APj li[j k "Guarantee me six things and I will guarantee you Paradise: when any one of you speaks, he should not lie; if he is entrusted with something, he should not betray that trust; if he makes a promise, he should not break it; lower your gaze; restrain your hands; and protect your private parts .»*2) Since looking provokes the heart to evil, Allah commanded (the believers) to protect their private parts just as he commanded them to protect their gaze which can lead to that. So he said: iTell the believing men to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts.} Sometimes protecting the private parts may involve keeping them from committing Zina, as Allah says: iAnd those who guard their chastity} [23:5]. Sometimes it may involve not looking at certain things, as in the Hadith in Musnad Ahmad and the Sunan: ajJL-yj t* j\ Si Ay «Guard your private parts except from your wife and those whom your right hands possess . 111 Fath Al-Bari 5 : 134 [2] Tarikh Al-Khatib 7:392, At-Tabarani in Al-Mu'jam Al-Kabir 8:314, Ibn Hibban in Al-Majruhm 2 :204. Ahmad 5:3, Abu Dawud 4:304, At-Tirmidhi 8:53, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 5 :313, Ibn Majah 1 :618

iiU'i iThat is purer for them .} means, it is purer for their hearts and better for their commitment to religion, as it was said: Whoever protects his gaze, Allah will illuminate his understanding, or his heart. ill iVerily, Allah is All-Aware of iwhat they do.} This is like the Ayah : 4 Cj yz} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes and all that the breasts conceal.} [40 :19] In the Sahih it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: uj ijBtji jyzit i Jus byJ ty\ k \$ Jj. _J» J k jSiVl tijj ijLiJl uU-Ul •*4& j>k £>ii j k y-&'j 'JJji "The son of Adam has his share of Zina decreed for him, and it will commit that which has been decreed. The Zina of the eyes is looking; the Zina of the tongue is speaking; the Zina of the ears is listening; the Zina of the hands is striking; and the Zina of the feet is walking. The soul wishes and desires, and the private parts confirm or deny that .« It was recorded by Al-Bukhari without a complete chain.111 Muslim recorded a similar report with a different chain of narration.121 Many of the Salaf said, "They used to forbid men from staring at beardless handsome boys." jk ^ ckjj ipA) it j ^ "1 if&Ao dUf?. % Lreser & ik*t t+4 Zir' \$ ' } 'k) dkp y J jCyi it ijffi 4^ -/? dyt-d JPP C jl crfk jS 'oiiA Fath Al-B&ri 1 1 :28 ' Muslim 4 :2047

* isg c pi ^ v; 5^« & !££ i djHri\$ LI!Ljr ji' Ijy j lrgi> 431. And tell the believing women to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts and not to show off their adornment except that which is apparent, and to draw their veils all over their Juyiib and not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husband's fathers, or their sons, or their husband's sons, or their brothers or their brother's sons, or their sister's sons, or their women, or their right hand possessions, or the Tdbi'Tn among men who do not have desire, or children who are not aware of the nakedness of women. And let them not stamp their feet so as to reveal what they hide of their adornment. And all of you beg Allah to forgive you all, O believers, that you may be successful.> The Rulings of Hijab This is a command from Allah to the believing women, and jealousy on His part over the wives of His believing servants. It is also to distinguish the believing women from the women of the Jdhiliyyah and the deeds of the pagan women. The reason for the revelation of this Ayah was mentioned by Muqatil bin Hayyan, when he said: "We heard - and Allah knows best - that Jabir bin 'Abdullah Al-Ansari narrated that Asma' bint Murshidah was in a house of hers in Bani Harithah, and the women started coming in to her without

lower garments so that the anklets on their feet could be seen, along with their chests and forelocks. Asma' said: *How ugly this is!' Then Allah revealed: 4f±jA It **3 4And tell the believing women to lower their gaze ...y^ And Allah says: 4And tell the believing women to lower their gaze} I 1 * This is a Mursal narration recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim , no. 14389.

68 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr meaning, from that which Allah has forbidden them to look at, apart from their husbands. [Some] scholars said that it is permissible for women to look at non-Mahram men without desire, as it was recorded in the SahXh that the Messenger of Allah was watching the Ethiopians playing with spears in the Masjid on the day of 'Id, and 'A'ishah the Mother of the believers was watching them from behind him and he was concealing her from them, until she got bored and went away. iand protect their private parts}. Said bin Jubayr said: "From immoral actions." Abu Al-'Aliyah said: "Every Ayah of the Qur'an in which protecting the private parts is mentioned means protecting them from Zina, except for this Ayah- cMAj? iand protect their private parts}, which means protecting them from being seen by anybody."*21 iand not to show off their adornment except that which is apparent,} means, they should not show anything of their adornment to non-Mahram men except for whatever it is impossible to hide. Ibn Maslid said: "Such as clothes and outer garments,'^3 Meaning what the Arab women used to wear of the veil which covered their clothes and whatever showed from underneath the outer garment. There is no blame on her for this, because this is something that she cannot conceal. Similar to that is what appears of her lower garment and what she cannot conceal. Al-Hasan, Ibn Sirin, Abu Al-Jawza', Ibrahim An-Nakhal and others also had the same view as Ibn MasHd.l4 *** Al-Bukhari no. 454, etc. Al-Tabari 19:154. Al-Tabari 19:156. [41 Al-Tabari 19:156.

iand to draw their veils all over their Juyub} means that they should wear the outer garment in such a way as to cover their chests and ribs, so that they will be different from the women of the JahiUyyah, who did not do that but would pass in front of men with their chests completely uncovered, and with their necks, forelocks, hair and earrings uncovered. So Allah commanded the believing women to cover themselves, as He says: 40 Prophet! Tell your wives and your daughters and the women of the believers to draw their cloaks all over their bodies. That will be better, that they should be known, so as not to be annoyed [33 :59] And in this noble Ayah He said: tlr^r» UP iand to draw their (Khumur) veils all over their JuyQb> Khumur (veils) is the plural of Khimar, which means something that covers, and is what is used to cover the head. This is

what is known among the people as a veil.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3937–3948]

Said bin Jubayr said: iand to draw} means to pull it around and tie it securely. &up*y itheir veils all aver their Juyub} means, over their necks and chests so that nothing can be seen of them. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: "May Allah have mercy on the women of the early emigrants. When Allah revealed the Ayah iand to draw their veils all over their Juyub}, they tore their *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :182 .

70 Tafstr Ibn Kathir aprons and Akhtamar*'* themselves with them."121 He also narrated from Safiyyah bint Shaybah that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, used to say: "When this Ayah: iand

to draw their veils all over their Juyub was revealed, they took their Izars (waistsheets) and tore them at the edges, and Akhtamarthemselves with them .”³¹ and not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husband's fathers, or their sons, or their husband's sons, or their brothers or their brother's sons, or their sister's sons,} All of these are a woman’s close relatives whom she can never marry (Mahram) and it is permissible for her to show her adornments to them, but without making a wanton display of herself. Ibn Al-Mundhir recorded that Ikrimah commented on this Ayah, icLpP \$ <<*>& iPA v] y id iand not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or theirfathers, or their husband's fathers...}, “The paternal uncle and maternal uncle are not mentioned here, because they may describe a woman to their sons, so a woman should not remove her Khimar in front of her paternal or maternal uncle.”⁴¹ With regard to the husband, all of this is for his sake, so she should try her best when adorning herself for him, unlike thewayshe should appear in front ofothers. Ill (2J HI However , it is obvious that others do not agree with this interpretation . It is not the place of the translators of this Tafstr to present their own views, especially when they may contradict the author’s Fath Al-Bari 8 :347 Path Al-Bari 8 :347 At-Tabari 19:160.

ijf&& ^or their women, this means that she may also wear her adornment in front of other Muslim women, but not in front of the women ofAhlAdh-Dhimmah (Jewish and Christian women), lest they describe her to their husbands. This is prohibited for all women, but more so in the case of the women of Ahl Adh- Dhimmah, because there is nothing to prevent them from doing that, but Muslim women know that it is unlawful and so, would be deterred from doing it. The Messenger of Allah jg said: ttlgUl jfc*. 5 L^>- ol^Jl oIjaJI C V® iNo woman should describe another woman to her husband so that it is as ifhe is looking at her. It was recorded in the Two Sahlhs from Ibn Mas'ud. ior their right hand possessions .} Ibn Jarir said, “This means from among the women of the idolators. It is permissible for a Muslim woman to reveal her adornment before such a woman, even if she is an idolatress, because she is her slave-girl.”² * This was also the view of Said bin Al-Musayyib.¹³ ’ Allah says; iTdbi'in among men who do not have desire,} such as hired servants and followers who are not at the same level as the woman and are feeble-minded and have no interest in or desire for women. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This is the kind of person who has no desire.”⁴¹ Ikrimah said, “This is the hermaphrodite, who does not experience erections.” This was also the view of others among the Salaf. It was narrated in the Sahih from ‘A’ishah that a 1,1 Path Al-Bari 9 :250 * At-Tabari 19:160. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:183. 141 At-Tabari 19:161.

hermaphrodite, used to enter upon the family of the Messenger of Allah sg and they used to consider him as one of those who do not have desire, but then the Messenger of Allah 2§ came in when he was describing a woman with four rolls of fat in front and eight behind. The Messenger of Allah sg said, 'i U |JLii IJU Vb eLo! I think this person knoius what is they are; he should never enter upon you . He expelled him, and he stayed in Al-Bayda’ and only came on Fridays to get food. 11 ! ior children who are not aware of the nakedness ofwomen.> Because they are so young they do not understand anything about women or their ‘Awrah or their soft speech or their enticing ways of walking and moving. If a child is small and does not understand that, there is nothing wrong with him entering upon women, but if he is an adolescent or approaching adolescence, so that he knows and understands these things, and can make a distinction between who is beautiful and who is not, then he should not enter upon women. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah sg; said: aAvoid entering upon women. It

was said, "O Messenger of Allah, what do you think about the male in-laws?" He said: "The male in-law is death. Muslim 4:1715, 1716, Ahmad 6:152, Abu Dawud 5:224, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :395 Fath Al-Bari 5 :242, Muslim 4:1171. Al-Hamu refers to the male in-laws that the woman may marry if she was divorced from her husband

73 Surah 24. An-Nur (31) (Part-18) The Etiquette of Women walking in the Street Allah's saying: iAtid let them not stamp their feet...} During Jahiliyyah, when women walked in the street wearing anklets and no one could hear them, they would stamp their feet so that men could hear their anklets ringing. Allah forbade the believing women to do this. By the same token, if there is any other kind of adornment that is hidden, women are forbidden to make any movements that would reveal what is hidden, because Allah says: iAnd let them not stamp their feet. . .} to the end of it. From that, women are also prohibited from wearing scent and perfume when they are going outside the home, lest men should smell their perfume. Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi recorded that Abu MQsa, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet jgs said: i\j&j o j\nn~ , »l bi sf LtA (1^ ' ' ' ' » «Every eye commits fornication and adultery, and when a woman puts on perfume and passes through a gathering, she is such and such - meaning an adulteress. He said, "And there is a similar report from Abu Hurayrah, and this is Hasan Sahfh.",1, It was also recorded by Abu Dawud and An-Nasal.*2 ' By the same token, women are also forbidden to walk in the middle of the street, because of what this involves of wanton display. Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Usayd Al-Ansari said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jgj, as he was coming out of the Masjid and men and women were mixing in the street, telling the women: fa] I oliliu jl Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:70. ' Abu Dawud 4 :400 , An-Nasal 8 :153

>> 4l§Ec8j^t ^6*0 '£4* Ot '\$ in 432. And marry those among you who are single (Al-Ayama) and the pious of your servants and maidservants. If they be poor, Allah will enrich them out of His bounty. And Allah is All-Sufficient, All-Knowing.} 433. And let those who find not the financial means for marriage keep themselves chaste, until Allah enriches them of His bounty. And such of your servants as seek a writing (of emancipation), give them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them. And give them something (yourselves) out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you. And force not your slave-girls to prostitution, if they desire chastity, in order that you may make a gain in the goods of this worldly life. But if anyone compels them, then after such compulsion, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 434. And indeed We have sent down for you Ayat that make things plain, and the example of those who passed away before you, and an admonition for those who have Taqwd.} The Command to marry These clear Ayat include a group of unambiguous rulings and firm commands. iAnd marry those among you wlu> are single (Al-Ayama)....} This is a command to many. The Prophet jg said: j j.W.1] Elli S;Gl {jA < > 'QJ j. <d ^jU ^j 'stL \ «0 young men, whoever among you can afford to get married, let him marry, for it is more effective in lowering the gaze and protecting the private parts. Whoever cannot do that, then let him fast, for it is a protection for him. This was recorded in the Two Sahihis from the Hadith of Ibn Mas^d. * In the Sunan, it was recorded from more than one m Path Al-Bari 9:14, Muslim 2:1019.

77 Surah 24. An-Nur (32 - 34) (Part-18) «There are three whom it is a right upon Allah to help: one who gets married seeking chastity; a slave who makes a contract with his master with the aim of buying his freedom ; and one who fights for the sake of Allah. This was recorded by Imam Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi,

An-Nasal and Ibn MajahJ The Prophet jg performed the marriage of a man who owned nothing but his waist wrap, and could not even buy a ring made of iron, but he still married him to that woman, making the Mahr his promise to teach her whatever he knew of the Qur'an. And it is known from the generosity and kindness of Allah that He provided him with whatever was sufficient for her and for him. TheCommand to keep OneselfChaste ifOne is not able to get married Allah's saying: / r .if •»' ' > * /. ' .V . .'"•'Ti, 4And let those who find not the financial means for marriage keep themselves chaste, until Allah enriches them of His bounty. This is a command from Allah to those who do not have the means to get married: they are to keep themselves chaste and avoid unlawful things, as the Prophet jfe said: j.W.l) j^Lij e.CJl^ j.-+* Ut «0 young men, wlwever among you can afford to get married, let him marry, for it is more effective in lowering the gaze and protecting the private parts. Wlwever cannot do that, then let him fast, for it is a protection for /iim.»121 This Ayah is general in meaning, and the Ayah in Surat An- Nisa.' is more specific, where Allah says: 111 Ahmad 2:251, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:296, An-Nasal 6:61, Ibn M§jah 2 :841 |2! Fath Al-Bari9:14.

78 Tafcir Ibn Kathir J f^L j\$ Jif) AAnd whoever ofyou have not the means wherewith to wedfree believing women) until His statement; iP% 142&) Abut it is betterfor you that you practise self-restraint) [4 :25 meaning, it is better for you to be patient and refrain from marrying slave-girl, because any child that is bom will also be a slave. jj*- «aL>F Aand Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful) [4 : 25]. AO& OJ V i "jjf AAnd let those who find not the financial means for marriage keep themselves chaste,) Iknmah said, "This refers to a man who sees a woman and it is as if he feels desire; if he has a wife then let him go to her and fulfill his desire with her, and if he does not have a wife, then let him ponder the kingdom of heaven and earth until Allah grants him means of livelihood." The Command to grant Slaves a Contract of Emancipation 4<Jlpp* jj pjzppp J£L £. iffo) AAnd such ofyour servants as seek a writing (ofemancipation) give them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them.) This is a command from Allah to slave-owners: if their servants ask them for a contract of emancipation, they should write it for them, provided that the servant has some skill and means of earning so that he can pay his master the money that is stipulated in the contract. Al-Bukhari said: "Rawh narrated from Ibn Jurayj: 1 said to 'Ata', "If I know that my servant has money, is it obligatory for me to write him a contract of emancipation?" He said, "I do

N, not think it can be anything but obligatory." 'Amr bin Dinar said: "I said to 'Ata', 'Are you narrating this from anybody?' He said, 'No,' then he told me that MQsa bin Anas told him that Sirin, who had a lot of money, asked Anas for a contract of emancipation and he refused. So he went to 'Umar (bin Al-Khattab), may Allah be pleased with him, and he said, "Write it for him.' He refused, so "Umar hit him with his whip and recited, igive them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them Then he wrote the contract." This was mentioned by Al- Bukhari with a disconnected chain of narration.11 ' It was also narrated by 'Abdur-Razzaq who said Ibn Jurayj told them: I said to 'Ata', "If I know that my servant has some money, is it obligatory for me to write him a contract of emancipation?" He said, *1 do not think it can be anything but obligatory."12 ' [It was also said by 'Amr bin Dinar who said, "I said to 'Ata', 'Are you narrating this from anybody?' He said, 'No.'") Ibn Jarir recorded that Sirin wanted Anas bin Malik to write a contract of emancipation and he delayed, then 'Umar said to him, "You should certainly write him a contract of emancipation." Its chain of narrators is Sahih,' 3' Allah's saying: (££ i\} ifyou find that there is good and honesty in them.) Some of them said (this

means) trustworthiness. Some said: “Honesty,” and others said: “A skill and ability to earn.” 4And give them something out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you.} This is the share of the wealth of Zakdh that Allah stated to be their right. This is the opinion of Al-Hasan, ‘Abdur-Rahman 111 FathAl-B&ri 5:219. ‘Abdur-Razz&q 8 :371 13’ At-Tabari 19:167.

bin Zayd bin Aslam and his father and Muqatil bin Hayyan. It was also the opinion favored by Ibn Jarir. Ofif «j(JU ji gioe them something out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you Ibrahim An-Nakhal said, “This is urging the people, their masters and others.” This was also the view of Buraydah bin Al-Husayb Al-Aslami and Qatadah. Ibn ‘Abbas said: “Allah commanded the believers to help in freeing slaves.”

The Prohibition of forcing One’s Slave-Girls to commit

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3948–3957]

Zina. Allah’s saying: iffff 1A/3 iAndforce not your slave-girls to prostitution Among the people of the Jahiliyyah, there were some who, if he had a slave-girl, he would send her out to commit Zina and would charge money for that, which he would take from her every time. When Islam came, Allah forbade the believers to do that. The reason why this Ayah was revealed, according to the reports of a number of earlier and later scholars of Tafsir, had to do with ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul. He had slave-girls whom he used to force into prostitution so that he could take their earnings and because he wanted them to have children which would enhance his status, or so he claimed. Reports narrated on this Topic In his Musnad, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Ahmad bin ‘Amr bin ‘Abd Al-Khaliq Al-Bazzar, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Az-Zuhri said, “Abdullah bin Ubayy bin SalQl had a slave- girl whose name was Mu'adhah, whom he forced into prostitution. When Islam came, the Ayah 1AJ3 iAnd force not your slave-girls to prostitution...> was At-Tabari 19 :173 , Al-Baghawi 3 :343

81Surah 24. An-Nur (32 - 34) (Part-18 revealed.”’ Al-A‘mash narrated from Abu Sufyan that Jabir said concerning this Ayah, “This was revealed about a slave-girl belonging to ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul whose name was Musaykah. He used to force her to commit immoral actions, but there was nothing wrong with her and she refused. Then Allah revealed this Ayah: 4And force not your saying; ' »>.' slave-girls to prostitution,} until His Crf\l 'ey \$ 1>UJZ yj} 4But if anyone compels them, then after such compulsion, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful An-Nasal also recorded something similar.’3 ’ Muqatil bin Hayyan said, “I heard - and Allah knows best - that this Ayah was revealed about two men who used to force two slave-girls of theirs (into prostitution). One of them was called Musaykah who belonged to [the Ansari], and Umaymah the mother of Musaykah belonged to ‘Abdullah bin Ubayy. Mu'adhah and Arwa were in the same situation. Then Musaykah and her mother came to the Prophet ^5 and told him about that. Then Allah revealed: &%} 4Andforce not your slave-girls to prostitution}, meaning Zina.’4 ’ 4C2 S3 l\} 4if they desire chastity,} means, if they want to be chaste, which is the case with the majority of slave-girls. 40^' ifP Jey IsQ} 4in order that you may make a gain in the goods of this worldly life.} ’ 1 KashfAl-Astar3 :6 1 [2’ At-Tabari 19:174. ’ An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :419 ’ Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :193

meaning, from the money they earn and their children. The Messenger of Allah forbade the money earned by the cupper, the prostitute and the fortune-teller. According to another report: V-JKJI “The earnings of a prostitute are evil, the earnings of a cupper are evil, and the price of a dog is evil.”¹³¹ Ibn Abi Talhah narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “If you do that, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful, and their sin will be on the one who forced them to do that.”¹⁴¹ This was also the view of Mujahid, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Al-A‘mash and Qatadah . After explaining these rulings in detail, Allah says: iAnd indeed We have sent down for you Ayat that make things plain,} meaning, in the Qur’an there are Ayat which are clear and explain matters in detail. oi *!&- ^| Si iand the example of those who passed away before you,} means, reports about the nations of the past and what happened to them when they went against the commandments of Allah, as Allah says: 111 Muslim 3:1198 Muslim 3:1199 131 An-Nasab in Al-Kubrd 6 :419 At-Tabari 19:175 At-Tabari 19:175, 176, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:195

iAnd We made them a precedent, and an example to later generations.} [43:56]; We made them a lesson, i.e., a rebuke for committing sin and forbidden deeds. ifor those who have Taqwa.} meaning, for those who remember and fear Allah. fa fafa ~far-> 4 {fat Q. 'fjPfa -jy> JS i fal 'fa. 'E/ % V 'f-y-j 'fafa-T -“Jd au’j j;lil J^pV' *u' »liJ jp «#’ cfJ^* 4? d6 -U* J'-i - 435. A//fl/i is the Light of the heavens and the earth. The parable of His Light is as a niche and within it a lamp : the lamp is in a glass, the glass as it were a star Durriyyun, lit from a blessed tree, an olive, neither of the east nor of the west, whose oil would almost glow forth, though no fire touched it. Light upon Light! Allah guides to His Light whom He wills. And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All- Knower of everything.} The Parable of the Light of Allah ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: iAllah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} means, the Guide of the inhabitants of the heavens and the earth. Ibn Jurayj said: “Mujahid and Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning the Ayah. iAllah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} He is controlling their affairs and their stars and sun and moon.”¹²¹ At-Jabari 19:177. •2| At-Tabari 19:177.

As-Suddi said concerning the Ayah: jy i\$} 4Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} by His Light the heavens and earth are illuminated. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “When the Messenger of Allah ^ got up to pray at night, he would say: jy ^ -W>JI <ilJj csflLil siu 'Crte iyj oiyLiil “O Allah, to You be praise, You are the Sustainer of heaven and earth and whoever is in them. To You be praise, You are the Light of the heavens and the earth and whoever is in them, a' 11 It was narrated that Ibn Mas‘ad said, “There is no night or day with your Lord; the Light of the Throne comes from the Light of His Face.”¹²¹ 4The parable of His Light} There are two views concerning the meaning of the pronoun (His). The first is that it refers to Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, meaning that the parable of His guidance in the heart of the believer is ias a niche} This was the view of Ibn ‘Abbas.¹³¹ The second view is that the pronoun refers to the believer, which is indicated by the context of the words and implies that the parable of the light in the heart of the believer is as a niche. So the heart of the believer and what he is naturally inclined to of guidance and what he learns of the Qur’an which is in accordance with his natural inclinations are, as Allah says: j\$} Fath Al-B&ri 5 :3 , Muslim 1 :532. See the discussion of Ayah no. 86 of Surat Al-Mu’minun. At-Jabari 19:179.

Can they who rely on a clear proof from their Lord, and whom a witness from Him recites it (can they be equal with the disbelievers)} [11:17]. The heart of the believer in its purity and clarity is likened to a lamp in transparent and jewel-like glass, and the Qur'an and Shar'ah by which it is guided are likened to good, pure, shining oil in which there is no impurity or deviation. (as if there were) a niche} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Muhammad bin Kab and others said, "This refers to the position of the wick in the lamp" 111 This is well-known, and hence Allah then says: ife*& iand within it a lamp.} This is the flame that burns brightly. Or it was said that the niche is a niche in the house. This is the parable given by Allah of obedience towards Him. Allah calls obedience to Him as light, then He calls it by other numerous names as well. Ubayy bin Kab said, "The lamp is the light, and this refers to the Qur'an and the faith that is in his heart."121 As-Suddi said, "It is the lamp." 4the lamp is in a glass,} means, this light is shining in a clear glass. Ubayy bin Kab and others said, "This is the likeness of the heart of the believer."131 4the glass as it were a star Durriyyun,} Some authorities recite the word Durriyyun with a Dammah on the Dal and without a Hamzah, which means pearls, i.e., as if it were a star made of pearls (Dun). Others recite it as Dirri'un or Durri'un, with a Kasrah on the Dal, or Dammah on the Dal, and with a Hamzah at the end, which means reflection [Dir], because if something is shone on the star it becomes brighter than at any other time. The Arabs call the stars they do not know DararL Ubayy bin At-Tabari 19:180, 183. At-Tabari 19:181 131 At-Tabari 19:178

so the sun reaches it morning and evening, so it is not counted as being in the east or in the west." if whose oil would almost glow forth (of itself), though no fire touched it.} 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said (this means) because the oil itself is shining. 4jy\$ 4Light upon Light!} Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that this meant the faith and deeds of a person.12 ' As-Suddi said: 4Light upon Light!} "Light of the fire and the light of the oil: when they are combined they give light, and neither of them can give light without the other. Similarly the light of the Qur'an and the light of faith give light when they are combined, and neither can do so without the other."13 ' 4&J o* -jyyi •**' 4Allah guides to His Light whom He wills.} means, Allah shows the way to the ones whom He chooses, as it says in the Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, who said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah say: JA ojj JA (j*J* ^ -fi. Ji\ p idtj iaii jiu- JiS 2)1 :Jji\ Jlj.il> ILu>- i ijj *Allah created His creation in darkness, then on the same day He sent His Light upon them. Whoever was touched by His Light on that day will be guided and whoever was missed will be led astray. Hence I say: the pens have dried in accordance with the knowledge of Allah, may He be glorifiedJ"14' At-Tabari 19:183. 121 Al-Tabari 19:182. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :202 141 Ahmad 2 :176.

j&'f& -rrir-HJ) 4And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All- Knower of everything.} Having mentioned this parable of the Light of His guidance in the heart of the believer, Allah ends this Ayah with the words: 4^Af \Zy iJity. «#'-rlr*K> 4And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All- Knower of everything meaning, He knows best who deserves to be guided and who deserves to be led astray. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said, "The Messenger of Allah 3^5 said: toyj* i ^ (jri k-JU j*yA\ v_JUi :y^Sll tili . v_Jia_j i ^j4j£1a <_JUi ^jSoJI «_JLa3 1 ufj i^ilSCJI i tiil uilpSII j <A ijtijj jUjJ <_~Lu "n . 1 4_..iaU L*f_j jw tfiJ i^yji jlls <j ju-Ji jijisliji idt UxJ aidi jLs <j jLL^j viii ^i Ui 4^ fin oHearts are of four kinds : the heart that is clear like a shining lamp; the heart that is covered and tied up; the heart that is upside-down; and the heart that is clad in armor. As for the clear heart, it is the heart of the believer in which is a lamp filled with light; as for the covered heart, this is

the heart of the disbeliever; as for the upside-down heart, this is the heart of the hypocrite, who recognizes then denies; as for the armor-clad heart, this is the heart in which there is both faith and hypocrisy. The parable of the faith in it is that of legume, a sprout that is irrigated with good water, and the Idleness of the hypocrisy in it is that of sores that are fed by blood and pus. Whichever of the two prevails is the characteristic that will dominate. m Ahmad 3 :17.

89Surah 24. Ati-Niir (36 - 38) (Part-18) Too e Igjf jlljj pAJj_> »* / /• y, *V** ./ // ^ t-jySp.^iiaP'i lj^p t_>L-^rtjO«lil,j^ L~i 0JL^jJ.s 2Upli I lai'A— ^ f"J 4j_sjj ,0 *»—' .*< * /> > o' •«* # - 4 •“' . ^-} iaJy 4>f^:IT*r, . •"-*' \> *t> f\ rf >> -/v \$J^U5^f5 . . Ao« ^ /,» !^ -//*' '*1/^>7^' < ^ ij^gap Its chain of narrators is good (Jayyid) although they (Al- Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it. J ft jil of£! £ gs. j£.f£ ^=4j v jc, ;n:^ij jijJC ?*' i5 o* J* X> tp« ^l>\$\ 0 d& c£ Pi & i^i :§ 4^Pa » ^ y>- (J, T'^AyyL-^ -A" *1^ a- <4j>_ <36. /« /louses wliidi Allah has ordered to be raised, in them His Name is remembered. Therein glorify Him in the mornings and in the evenings,) <37. Men whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah nor from performing the Salah nor from giving the Zakdh . Theyfear a Day when hearts and eyes will be overturned.) <38 . That Allah may reward them according to the best of their deeds, and add even morefor them out ofHis grace. And Allah provides without measure to whom He wills.)

The Virtues of the Masjids, the Correct Etiquette, and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3957–3976]

the Virtues ofThosewho take care ofthem Having likened the heart of the believer and what it contains of guidance and knowledge to a lamp lit with good oil shining in a clear glass, Allah then states where it belongs, which is in the Masjids, the places on earth that are most beloved to

remembered, Allah will buildfor him a house in Paradise .s' 1 An-Nasat mentioned something similar There are very many Hadtths which say this. 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: "The Messenger of Allah 5\$g commanded us to build Masjids among the houses, and to clean them and perfume them." This was recorded by Ahmad and the Sunan compilers with the exception of An-Nasal. Ahmad and Abu Dawud recorded a similar report from Samurah bin Jundub . Al-Bukhari said: "Umar said: 'Build for the people a place to worship Allah, and beware of using red or yellow for adornment and decoration and distracting the people thereby. 1' "<5> Abu Dawud narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: «/ was not commanded to Tashyld the Masjids .» Ibn 'Abbas said, "Decorating them as the Jews and Christians did."161 Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: j >(1)1 J>\2 Jj. ULUl y» "The Hour will not come until people show off in building Masjids . It was recorded by Ahmad and the compilers of the Sunan, with the exception of At-Tirmidhi.17' Buraydah narrated that a man called out in the Masjid and Ibn Mfijah 1 :243. An-Nasal 2 : 31 Ahmad 6:279, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 3 :206, Ibn Mdjah 1 :250. ' Ahmad 5:17, Abu Dawud 1 :310. ^ 1 Fath Al-Ban 1 :642 . This was stated by Al-Bukhari without a chain ofnarration ' Abu Dawud 1 :310. Ahmad 3:134, Abu Dawud 1:311, An-Nasal 2:32, Ibn Majah

It is confirmed in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah said: Ji3 *->. Ij. j* J Y) ^ Jj gy>- p aij-ffj lij if viiJjjUi_e> Jj> li)i «1* lij i>-3^ Ifj i Y) sjli Uj jU Y) .-uji-jl j^Ill Jjj j^iji J pS U <11* JJa, a&Y-JI

JJ; j&i u ;YU>j Jij; «A matt's prayer in congregation is twenty-five times better than his prayer in his house or the marketplace. That is because ifhe performs Wudu' and does it well, then he goes out to go to the Masjid, and for no other purpose than to pray, he does not take one step but he increases in one level in status and one sin is removed. When he prays, the angels continue sending blessings on him as long as he is in the place where he prays, [they say], "O Allah, send blessings on him, O Allah, have mercy on him." And he will remain in a state of prayer as long as he is waiting for the prayer . »W The following is recorded in the Sunan: .yuii ffii jJljkj Ji *Those who walk to the Masjids when it is dark, give them the glad tidings of complete Light on the Day of Resurrection When entering the Masjid, it is recommended to enter with one's right foot, and to say the supplication recorded in Sahih Al-Bukhari, where it is narrated from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr that the Messenger of Allah jg used to say, when he entered the Masjid: ollij .) l ja ipjjijl AilkLUj .b«H <uL "I seek refuge with Allah Almighty and with His Noble Face, and with His Eternal Domain, from the accursed ShaytanJ [He (one of the narrators) asked. Is that all?' He answered, 'Yes'). If he says this, the Shaytan says: "He will be protected * Al-Bukhari 647, Muslim 649. Abu D&wud 561 , At-Tirmidhi 223.

from me all day long." Muslim recorded that Abu Humayd or Abu Usayd said: The Messenger of Allah jg said: «iiUi jt iiSuf J i/^Sii :jii «kWien anyone of you enters the Masjid, let him say: "O Allah, open the gates of Your mercy for me. And when he comes out, let him say: "O Allah, I ask You of Your bounty."*™ An-Nasal also recorded this from them from the Prophet \$g. Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said: The Messenger of Allah jg said: Je ^& 'H jUadjI JA p-i^ J^3 ^r"^ <£> *H3 "^^0 oWteen anyone o/ yon enters the Masjid, let him invoke blessings on the Prophet then let him say: "O Allah, open the gates of Your mercy for me." When he comes out, let him invoke blessings on the Prophet and say, "O Allah, protect me from the accursed Shaytan This was also recorded by Ibn Majah, as well as Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Hibban in their Sah£hs.'4 ' iin them His Name is remembered> meaning, the Name of Allah. This is like the Ayat. 40 Children of Adam! Take your adornment to every Masjid...» 17:31] l1 ' Abu Dawud 2 :318. ™ Muslim 1 :494 ' An-Nasal 2 :53 ' Ibn MAjah 1 :254 , Ibn Khuzaymah 1 :231 , Ibn Hibban 3 :246, 247

A iM x£ 1/om shouldface (Him only) in each and every Masjid, and invoke Him only making your religion sincere to Him [7:29]. 4*“ iAnd the Masjids arefor Allah> [72:18]. iin them His Name is remembered.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means that His Book is recited therein." 1 ' 4iJU>'5ib jiilL /! 4Therein glorify Him in the mornings and in the evenings.} li &£H ^ v 4Men whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance ofAllah} This is like the Ayat 0M>* Si* <\$£} 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert youfrom the remembrance ofAllSh.} [63:9J l)jj jJi! JS IjilS fiiijl •Aj! <jj sjM. 'iSiy 'H !>*** Cti! 40 i/oh who believe! When the call is proclaimed for the Salah on Friday, hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah and leave offbusiness [62:9] Allah says that this world and its adornments, attractions and marketplaces should not distract them from remembering their Lord Who created them and sustains them, those who know that what is with Him is better for them than what they themselves possess, because what they have is transient but that which is with Allah is eternal. Allah says: «#! Jb& Vj '(M, [11 At-Tabari 19:191.

iMen whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah nor from performing the Salah nor from giving the Zakahi. meaning, they give priority to obeying Allah and doing what He

wants and what pleases Him over doing what they want and what pleases them. It was reported from Salim from 'Abdullah bin Umar that he was in the marketplace when the Iqamah for prayer was called, so they closed their stores and entered the Masjid. Ibn Umar said: "Concerning them the Ayah was revealed: * c? " , . •> • » > v iMen whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah⁴ . This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. iMen xvhom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Alldhi. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This meant from the prescribed prayers."*2 ' This was also the view of Muqatil bin Hayyan and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas. As-Suddi said: "From prayer in congregation." Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "That does not distract them from attending the prayer and establishing it as Allah commanded them, and from doing the prayers at the prescribed times and doing all that Allah has enjoined upon them in the prayer." '4-1\$* m Cjt iTheyfear a Day when hearts and eyes will be overturned. means, the Day of Resurrection when people's hearts and eyes will be overturned, because of the intensity of the fear and terror of that Day. This is like the Ayah: ifify" (4J4j\$ iAnd warn them of the Day that is drawing near...> [40:18), *** Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2607 * At-Tabari 19:193.

Surat 24. An-Nur (36 - 38) (Part-18) 97 ibut He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror 14 :42]. f) 'Afr fci -K/ ^ \$ #wi 1*1 //•' 'ff if Aft •jU> piA) oJI'j j-. *»' CJj 'fCM &£j} <j£a £& C£ t) c* G] ^jUh *** **} fi'srJ iAnd they givefood, inspite of their love for it, to the poor, the orphan, and the captive, (saying:) "Wefeel you seeking Allah's Face only. We zoish for no reward, nor thanks from you. Verily, Wefearfrom our Lord a Day, hard and distressful, that will make thefaces look horrible." So Allah saved themfrom the evil of that Day, and gave them a light ofbeauty and joy. And their recompense shall be Paradise, and silken garments, because they were patient} [76 :8-12]. And Allah says here: i\u \$T)iat Allah may reward them according to the best of their deeds,} meaning, "They are those from whom We shall accept the best of their deeds and overlook their evil deeds." i-Ar^ ui (**-}yy^ iand add even morefor than out ofHis grace.} means, He will accept their good deeds and multiply them for them, as Allah says: ;jS Olii* v iii iSurely , Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust.} [4 :40] ^Whoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit.} 6 :160]

iWlw is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan.} (2:245] JJ %) iAllah gives manifold increase to whom He wills.} (2:261) And Allah says here: i!u. }And Allah provides without measure to whom He wills.} hr— f 'ij »L ohililf *1— c /Li CJ^j} -<j ^ j c .J laT Jjj iilj fX£ <i' LLjj i".'^ m "l 7', . " •')> / - .-r - Hiii Jr c.«—Ll> ^ .oy ^ & \$& !>> \$ «i>' /"?- 3 ^39. As /or f/iöse io/io disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a QVah. The thirsty one thinks it to be water until he comes up to it, hefinds it to be nothing; but hefinds Allah with him, Who will pay him his due. And Allah is swift in takinv account.} } 40. Or like the darkness in a vast deep sea, overwhelmed with waves topped by waves, topped by dark clouds, (layers of) darkness upon darkness : ifa man stretches out his hand, he can hardly see it! And he for whom Allah has not appointed light, for him there is no light.} Two Examples oftwo kinds of Disbelievers These are two examples which Allah sets forth of two kinds of disbelievers. Similarly He sets forth two parables of the hypocrites at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah: one involving fire and the other involving water. 1 11 Similarly, in Surat Ar- Ra'd He gives two parables of the guidance and knowledge that are instilled in the heart, again involving fire and water;121 we have discussed each of them in the appropriate place and there is no need to repeat it here, praise be to Allah. The first of these

two examples is that of the disbelievers who call See SuratAl-Baqarah [2:17-19]. 121 See Surat Ar-Ra'd [13 : 17]

others to their disbelief, thinking that they have good actions and beliefs, when this is not in fact the case. Their likeness is that of a mirage which is seen in a desert plain, looking from a distance as if it is a deep sea. The word QVah refers to a vast, flat, level area of land in which the mirage may appear. There are different kinds of mirage, one which appears after midday, and another which appears in the morning and looks like water between heaven and earth. If a person who is in need of water sees the mirage, he thinks that it is water so he heads towards it in order to drink from it, but when he reaches it, i\kl '.J4)} ihe finds it to be nothing.}; Similarly the disbeliever thinks that he is doing something good and that he has achieved some- thing, but when Allah judges him on the Day of Resurrection, and brings him to account and examines his deeds, he will find that nothing has been accepted at all, either because of a lack of sincere belief or because he did not follow the proper ways of the Shari'ah. As Allah says: 4 jit & u \$And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} [25:23]. And He says here: iilfj *ijj» iXi iii J~jj} ibut he finds Allah with him, who will pay him his due. And Allah is swift in taking account.} A similar view was also narrated from Ubayy bin Kab, Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and others.¹¹ ' In the Two Sahlhs, it is reported that on the Day of Resurrection it will be said to the Jews, "What did you used to worship?" They will say, "We used to worship TJzayr the son of Allah." It will be said to them, "You have lied. Allah has not begotten a son. What do you want?" They will say, "O Lord, we are thirsty, give us something to drink." It will be said to them, "Do you not see?" Then Hell will be shown to them as if PI At-Tabari 19:196.

4Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him [7:186] This is in contrast to what Allah says about the believers: 4Q o' -AU-l ii' s£-) iAllah guides to His Light whom He wills. [24:35] We ask Allah the Almighty to put light in our hearts and give us light on our right and on our left, and to increase us in light. jje Ji y 4 O* % j j-5 'U m , (* ' rtf' All' UJ rfUp All'j >J 441 . See you not that Allah, He it is Whom glorify whosoever is in the heavens and the earth, and the birds with wings outspread? Of each one He knows indeed his Salah and his glorification; and Allah is All-Aware of ivhat they do. 442. And to Allah belongs the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth, and to Allah is the return. Everything glorifies Allah, may He be exalted, and to Him belongs the Sovereignty Allah tells us that whosoever is in the heavens and on the earth, i.e., the angels, mankind. Jinn, animals and even inanimate objects, all glorify Him. This is like the Ayah: tit* £> 'i 4The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him) [17:44], 4and the birds with ivings outspread) means, while they are flying they glorify their Lord and worship Him with the glorification with which they are inspired and to which they are guided. Allah knows what they are doing, and so He says: 40feach one He knows indeed his Salah and his glorification ;) meaning, He has guided every creature to its own way of

them together, then makes them into a heap of layers, and you see the rain come forthfrom between them ; and He sends down from the sky, from mountains in it of ice, and strikes therewith whom He wills, and averts it from whom He wills. The vivid flash of its (clouds) lightning nearly blinds the sight.) 444. Allah causes the night and the day to succeed each other. Tndy, in this is indeed a lesson for those who have insight.) The Power ofAllah to create the Clouds and thatwhich comes fromThem Allah

tells us that He drives the clouds from the beginning, when they are formed and are still weak. This is the “Gentle driving.” 4then joins them together,) means, He brings them together after they have been scattered. Wfckp 4then makes them into a heap of layers,) means. He piles them up on top of one another. 4and you see the Wadq) meaning the rain, 4come forth from between them;) means, from the gaps between them. This is how it was understood by Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak.’ ‘Ubayd bin Tlmayr Al-Laythi said: “Allah sends the scatterer [wind], which stirs up that which is on the surface of the earth. Then he sends the generator [wind], which forms the clouds. Then He sends the joiner [wind] which brings them together. Then He sends the fertilizer [wind] which fertilizes or ‘seeds’ the clouds.” This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir.’2’ U Jt hi I 1 ’ At-Tabari 19:202. ,2’ At-Jabari 19:201

and He sends down from [Min] the sky, from [Min] mountains in it of [Min] ice,} Some of the grammarians said that the first Min describes the place from which it is coming, the second specifies from which part of the sky it comes, and the third means some kind of mountains. This is based on the view of those scholars of Tafsir who say that, if* U& yfr ifrom [Min] mountains in it of [Min] ice means that there are mountains of hail in the sky from which Allah sends down ice. As for those who say that “mountains” here is used as a metaphor for clouds, they think that the second Min is also used to describe the place from which the ice is coming, and is thus interchangeable with the first. And Allah knows best. and strikes therewith whom He wills, and averts it from whom He wills.} It may be that the phrase i’ii and strikes therewith} means, with what He sends down from the sky of different kinds of rain and hail. So then the phrase and strikes therewith whom He wills} means, by His mercy towards them, and and averts it from whom He wills.} means, He withholds rain from them. Or it may be that and strikes therewith} means, with hail, as a punishment towards whomever He wills, striking their fruits and destroying their crops and trees. And He averts it from whomever He wills as a mercy towards them.

iThe vivid flash of its lightning nearly blinds the sight.) the brightness of its lightning almost takes away their sight if the eyes follow it and try to look at it. j3f&4S> iAllah causes the night and the day to succeed each other.) He is controlling them, so that He takes something from the length of one and adds it to the other, which is short, until they become equal, then He does the opposite so that the one which was short becomes long and vice versa. Allah is the One Who is controlling that by His command, power, might and knowledge. ifSZtif tsjd# 4 d5[) iTruly, in this is indeed a lesson for those who have insight.) means, this is an indication of His greatness, may He be exalted. This is like the Ayah: 4^ oy*-- *’ 4^ 4 iVerily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding.) [3:190] and thereafter. cy (*rV i & L>r*i J* (*r^ 4* Jt E’>y 4^ li\ "XZ U ill ji* if jfX 445. Allah has created every moving creature from water. Of them there are some that creep on their bellies, and some that walk on two legs, and some that walk on four. Allah creates what He wills. Verily, Allah is able to do all things.) Allah’s Power in His creation of the Animals Allah mentions His complete and almighty power to create all the different kinds of animals with their various forms, colors and ways of moving and stopping, from one kind of water. & t&i cy (>&) Of them there are some that creep on their bellies,) like snakes and so on;

and some that walk on two legs,} like humans and birds; i{3 && and some that walk on four,} like cattle and all kinds of animals. Allah says: i*Qj ill ij&z} iAllah creates what He wills.} meaning by His

power, because what He wills happens and what He does not will does not happen. So he says: *Verily, Allah is able to do all things.* And Allah guides whom He wills to the straight path. Allah states that in this Qur'an He has revealed many clear and unambiguous rulings, words of wisdom and parables, and that He guides people of understanding, insight and intellect to ponder and understand them. He says: *And Allah guides whom He wills to the Straight Path.* They say: "We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and we obey," then a party of them turn away thereafter, such are not believers. And when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to

judge between them, to! a party of them refuses and turns away. But if the truth is on their side, they come to him wittingly with submission. Is there a disease in their hearts? Or do they doubt or fear lest Allah and His Messenger should wrong them in judgement. Nay, it is they themselves who are the wrongdoers. The only saying of the faithful believers, when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is that they say: "We hear and we obey." And such are the successful. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, fears Allah, and has Taqwa of Him, such are the successful. The Treachery of the Hypocrites and the Attitude of the Believers Allah tells us about the characteristics of the hypocrites who show one thing while hiding another, and who say with their tongues, "We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and we obey," then a party of them turn away thereafter, meaning, their actions contradict their deeds, and they say that which they do not do. Allah says: *such are not believers.* And when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them... means, when they are asked to follow the guidance which Allah has revealed to His Messenger, they turn away and are too arrogantly proud of themselves to follow him. This is like the Ayah

Have you not seen those who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you, until His saying: *you see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion* [4:60-61]. But if the truth is on their side, they come to him willingly with submission. means, if the ruling will be in their favor and not against them, then they will come and will listen and obey, which is

what is meant by the phrase

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willingly with submission. But if the ruling will go against him, he turns away and demands something that goes against the truth, and he prefers to refer for judgement to someone other than the Prophet, so that his false claims may prevail. His acceptance in the beginning was not because he believed that it was the truth, but because it happened to be in accordance with his desires. So when the truth went against what he was hoping for, he turned away from it. Allah said: *Strive against them, they will turn away from you with aversion*... meaning, their situation cannot be anything else, they must necessarily have a disease in their hearts, or else they have some doubts about the religion, or they are afraid that Allah and His Messenger will be unjust in their ruling against them. Whichever it is, it is pure disbelief, and Allah knows which of these characteristics each one of them has. Nay, it is they themselves who are

the wrongdoers.} means, they are the evildoers who commit immoral actions, and Allah and His Messenger jg are innocent of the injustice and unfairness that they imagine; exalted be Allah and His Messenger above such a thing.

109Surah 24. An-Nur (47 - 52) (Part-18) Then Allah tells us about the attributes of the believers who respond to Allah and His Messenger jg and who seek no other way apart from the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger jg. Allah says: 477ie o«/y sai/mg o/ the faithfiil believers, when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is tluit they say : “We hear and we obey” meaning, to hear to obey. Allah describes them as having attained success, which is achieving what one wants and being saved from what one fears. So Allah says: 4And such are the successful. Concerning the Ayah: hl: \ j& 4they say : “We hear and we obey” Qatadah said: “We were told that when Tjbadah bin As- Samit, who had been present at Al-‘Aqabah and at Badr, and was one of the leaders of the Ansar, was dying, he said to his nephew Junadah bin Abi Umayyah: ‘Shall I not tell you what you must do and what is your due?’ He said, ‘Yes.’ He said: You have to listen and obey when times are easy and when they are hard, when you feel energetic and when you do not want to, and when you feel selfish. You have to train your tongue to speak the truth. Do not go against those who are in authority, unless they openly command you to commit acts of disobedience to Allah. Whenever you are commanded to do something that goes against the Book of Allah, then follow the Book of Allah.”111 Qatadah said: We were told that Abu Ad-Darda’ said, “There is no Islam except through obedience to Allah, and no goodness except in Jama'ah. Sincerity is to Allah and His Messenger jg, and to the Khallfah and all the believers.” He said: “And we were told that Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah m Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2623

no Tafslr Ibn Kathir be pleased with him, used to say; ‘The bonds of Islam are La ilah a illallah , establishing prayer, paying Zakah and obeying those whom Allah has given authority over the affairs of the Muslims.’” This was recorded by Ibn Abi HatimJ ' There are very many Hadiths and reports which state that it is obligatory to obey the Book of Allah, the Sunnah of His Messenger, the Rightly-Guided Khallfahs and the Imams when they command us to obey Allah; there are too many of these reports to quote them all here. -#50m r“v *mm#mmm "W, x -i ^ ^ v 4-Amf whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger,} in what he is commanded with, and avoid what he is forbidden, ifears Allah,} means, for his past sins, iand has Taqwa ofHim,} regarding sins he may commit in the future. m Ibn Abi Hatim 8 : 2623 , 2624

4such are the successful.} means, those who will attain sill goodness and be saved from all evil in this world and the Hereafter. <oit 0^ .OJ/o AcIl, j^ « m . »i V Ji ('TV' ^ r. *J !>*—•!) t* U L3ji \j)y ^ !>«r^ ji , rj" L-J 4®^*i' ^ jA!)> £ 4, L ^53 . They swear by Allah their strongest oaths that ifonly you would order them, they would leave. Say: "Swear you not; obedience is known. Verily, Allah knows well what you do."} 454. Say: "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger, but if you turn away, he is only responsible for the duty placed on him and you for that placed on you. If you obey him, you shall be on the right guidance. The Messenger's duty is only to convey (the Message) in a clear way."} Allah says about the hypocrites who had promised the Messenger jg and sworn that if he were to command them to go out for battle, they would go: }Say : "Swear you not..."} meaning, do not swear this oath. 4cU»^ iobedience is known.} It was said that the meaning is, your obedience is known, i.e., it is known that your obedience is merely verbal and is not accompanied by action. Every time you swear an oath you lie.

This is like the Ayah 4[^] \£jl fesA Sf&} 4They swear to you that you may be pleased with them...} [9:96] And Allah says: 4They have made their oaths a screen (for their evil actions).} [58:16]

112 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr It is part of their nature to tell lies, even in the issues they choose, as Allah says: ujiyb \yjfc ^sfk\ jl j ^1^ 0^3 pi&% 'M& <4 £i && ^ ^DA r^-ir* Aj pjAt y Vjy 4-> r*~ ^sv*. ^ A iHave you not observed the hypocrites who say to their friends among the people of the Scripture who disbelieve: "If you are expelled, we indeed will go out with you, and we shall never obey any one against you; and if you are attacked, we shall indeed help you." But Allah is Witness that they verily are liars. Surely, if they are expelled, never will they go out with them ; and if they are attacked, they will never help them . And if they do help them, they will turn their backs, and they will not be victorious .} [59:1 1-12] Then Allah says: 44 2>' iSay: "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger...} meaning, follow the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger \$ig. ibut if you turn aivay,} if you ignore what he has brought to you, <\$ c£ <{%} ihe is only responsible for the duty placed on him), conveying the Message and fulfilling the trust. iand you for that placed on you accepting that, and venerating it and doing as it commanded. dj} ilf you obey him, you shall be on the right guidance.} because he calls to the straight path,

477ie path of Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth...} [42:53] 477ie Messenger's duty is only to convey in a clear way.} This is like the Ayat. iSj ^i/our duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} 13:4°] UJJ » <*> J lij U.] 4So remind them - you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.} [88:21-22] *->*" j»rti o4^J (*+ti jj 4l»3oA- jt* vitpljti -*X _>£==> <>•> till ,_j V 455. Allah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before them, and that He will grant them the authority to practise their religion which He has chosen for them . And He will surely give them in exchange a safe security after theirfear if they worship Me and do not associate anything with Me. But whoever disbelieved after this, they are the rebellious.} Allah's Promise to the Believers that He would grant them Succession This is a promise from Allah to His Messenger that He would cause his Ummah to become successors on earth, i.e., they would become the leaders and rulers of mankind, through whom He would reform the world and to whom people would submit, so that they would have in exchange a safe security after their fear. This is what Allah did indeed do, may He be glorified and exalted, and to Him be praise and blessings. For He did not cause His Messenger jfe to die until

114 Tafstr IbtI Kathir He had given him victoiy over Makkah, Khaybar, Bahrayn, all of the Arabian Peninsula and Yemen; and he took Jizyah from the Zoroastrians of Hajar and from some of the border lands of Syria; and he exchanged gifts with Heraclius the ruler of Byzantium, the ruler of Egypt and Alexandria, the Muqawqis, the kings of Oman and An-Najashi of Abyssinia, who had become king after Ashamah, may Allah have mercy on him and grant him honor. Then when the Messenger died, his successor (Khalifah) Abu Bakr As-Siddlq took over the reins of power and united the Ummah, preventing its disintegration. He took control of the entire Arabian Peninsula, and he sent the Islamic armies to the land of Persia, under the leadership of Khalid bin Al- Walid, may Allah be pleased with him, who conquered a part of it and killed some of its people. He sent another army under the leadership of Abu TJbaydah, may Allah be pleased with him, and the other commanders who came after

him in the lands of Syria. He sent a third army under the leadership of ‘Amr bin Al-‘As, may Allah be pleased with him, to Egypt. Allah enabled the army sent to Syria to conquer Busra and Damascus and their provinces the land of Hawran and its environs. Then Allah chose for Abu Bakr to honor him with Him and he died. The people of Islam were blessed that A?-Siddiq was inspired to appoint ‘Umar Al-FarQq as his successor, so he took the reins of power after him and did a perfect job. After the Prophets, the world never saw anyone like ‘Umar in excellence of conduct and perfect justice. During his time, the rest of Syria and Egypt, and most of Persia, was conquered. Kisra was defeated and utterly humiliated, and he retreated to the furthest point of his kingdom. Mighty Caesar was brought low, his rule over Syria was overthrown, and he retreated to Constantinople. Their wealth was spent for the sake of Allah, as the Messenger of Allah had foretold and promised. May Allah’s perfect peace and purest blessing be upon him. During the rule of ‘Uthman, the Islamic domains spread to the furthest points of the earth, east and west. The lands of the west were conquered as far as Cyprus and Andalusia, Kairouan’ 1 ’ I 1 * During the author’s time, this city was the capital of Tunisia.

and Sebta which adjoins the Atlantic Ocean. Towards the east, the conquests extended as far as China. Kisra was killed, his kingdom was utterly destroyed and the cities of Iraq, Khurasan and Al-Ahwaz were conquered. The Muslims killed a great number of Turks and Allah humiliated their great king Khaqan. Taxes were collected from the east and the west, and brought to the Commander of the faithful “Uthman bin ‘Affan, may Allah be pleased with him. This was a blessing brought by his recitation and study of the Qur’an, and his bringing the Ummah together to preserve and protect it. In the Sahih it was recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said: J isjj ^ oJy ^ ,jjj 2j | «Allah showed me the earth and I looked at the east and the west. The dominion of my Ummah will reach everywhere I was shown. » (I1 And now we are enjoying that which Allah and His Messenger jg promised us, for Allah and His Messenger jg spoke the truth. We ask Allah to give us faith in Him and His Messenger, and to help us to give thanks to Him in a manner that will earn us His pleasure. 4Allah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before them, and that He will grant them the authority to practise their religion which He has chosen for them. And He will surely, give them in exchange a safe security after their fear. Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas narrated that Abu Al-‘Aliyah said, “The Prophet jg and his Companions were in Makkah for nearly ten years, calling people in secret to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. They were in a state of fear and were not instructed to fight until after they were commanded to migrate I 1 ’ Muslim 4 :22 15

116 Tafslr Ibn Kathir to Al-Madinah. When they came to Al-Madinah, then Allah instructed them to fight. In Al-Madinah they were afraid and they carried their weapons morning and evening. This is how they remained for as long as Allah willed...” Then Allah revealed this Ayah. He caused His Prophet to prevail over the Arabian Peninsula, and then they felt safe and put down their weapons. Then Allah took His Prophet jg and they remained safe throughout the time of Abu Bakr, ‘Umar and ‘Uthman, until what happened happened, and fear again prevailed over them, so they instituted a police force and guards. They changed, so their situation changed. One of the Salaf said, “The Khilafah of Abu Bakr and Umar was true and adhered to the Book of Allah. Then he recited this Ayah.” Al-Bara bin ‘Azib said, “This Ayah was revealed when we were in a state of extreme fear.”¹²¹ This Ayah is like the Ayah: r> ' .>< . v Jr* H } iAttd remember when you were few and were reckoned weak in the land} Until His

statement: iso that you might be gratefulj* [8:26]. 4^u 1 1Ck=^} ias He granted succession to those before them,} This is like the Ayah where Allah tells us that Musa said to his people: ^ J j\$2j Cr*} i "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enetny and make you successors on the earth ..."} [7:129] And Allah says: / .» • 4d;Si\ At-Tabari 19 :209. A shorter version was recorded by Al-Hakim. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6:215.

117Surah 24. An-Nur (55) (Part-18) iAttd We wished to do a favor to those who were weak in /lie land,) until the two Ayat there after. (28:5-6] ip& j&j fS <and that He will grant them the authority to practise their religion which He has chosen for them...) As the Messenger of Allah said to 'Adiyy bin Hatim when he came to him in a delegation: 5Vo Ojju I «Do you know Al-Hirah? He said, "I do not know it, but I have heard of it."The Messenger ofAllah jg said: jtj* cr. j'>r «By flie One in Whose Hand is my soul, Allah will make this matter [i.e., Islam] prevail until a woman riding a camel will come from Al-Hirah™ and perform Tawaf around the House without needing the protection of anybody, and the treasures of Kisra the son ofHurmuz will be opened.» He said, "Kisra the son of Hurmuz?" He said, •jU-1 3\$ i Ji- JUJI ,y'fb ^ ^-jLS «Yes, Kisra the son ofHurmuz, and wealth will be given until there will be no one who will accept it.® 'Adiyy bin Hatim said: "Now it is happening that a woman riding a camel comes from Al-Hirah and performs Tawaf around the House without needing the protection of anybody, and I was among those who opened the treasure of Kisra the son of Hurmuz. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, the third thing will also come to pass, because the Messenger of Allahm said it."121 iif they worship Me and do not associate anything with Me.) Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas that Mu'adh bin Jabal told A section ofmodem Iraq. * Ahmad 4 :257 . Similarwas recorded by Al-Bukhari no . 3595

punish them This was also recorded in the Two Sahihs. jU lijijti iX _>i=> iBut whoever disbelieved after this, they are the rebellious means, "whoever then stops obeying Me after that, has stopped obeying the command of his Lord, and that is a great sin.' The Companions - may Allah be pleased with them - were the most committed of people after the Prophet jg to the commands of Allah and the most obedient to Allah. Their victories were in accordance with their level of commitment. They caused the Word of Allah to prevail in the east and the west, and Allah supported them so much that they governed all the people and all the lands. When the people subsequently fell short in their commitment to some of the commandments, their strength and victory fell short accordingly, but it is confirmed through more than one route in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah^ said: Wfje iThere will remain a group of my Ummah adhering to the truth, and those whoforsake them or oppose them will not harm them until the Day ofResurrection . b|3) According to another report: jU} jit J>-» until the command of Allah comes to pass and they are like that ,»'4 ' According to another report: «... until they fight the DajjSiM51 111 Ahmad 5:242. Fath Al-B&rri 10:412, Muslim 1 :58. 131 Muslim 1 :137. '4| Muslim 3:1523. 151 Ahmad 437.

120 Tafstr IbtI Kathtr According to another report: « ^S. J "J J^1 «... until 'Isa bin Maryam comes down and they are prevailing .s* 11 All of these reports are Sahih, and there is no contradiction between them. V && \J4j •\$(ijCj \jj;} Jjjj %\ j&fc UyVf 4 156. And perform the Salah, and give the Zakah and obey the Messenger that you may receive mercy.} 157. Consider not that the disbelievers can escape in the land. Their abode shall be the Fire - and worst indeed is that destination.} The Command to pray,

give the Zakah and obey the Messengers; the inability of the Disbelievers to escape, and the ultimate Destiny Allah commands His believing servants to establish prayer, which means worshipping Allah Alone with no partner or associate; to pay the Zakah, which is an act of kindness towards His poor and weak creatures; and by doing so to obey the Messenger of Allah jg, i.e., to do as he commands them and to avoid what he forbids them-, so that Allah will have mercy on them for that. No doubt, whoever does that, Allah will have mercy on him, as Allah says in another Ayah: iAlldh will have His mercy on them} [9:71] iU^i} iConsider not} means, 'do not think, O Muhammad', that: ^U\$} ithe disbelievers} meaning, those who opposed and denied you, Fath Al-Bari 13:306.

121 Surah 24. An-Niir (56 - 60) (Part-18) icon escape in the land.} means, that they can flee from Allah. No, Allah is able to deal with them and He will punish them most severely for that. Allah says: iTheir abode} meaning, in the Hereafter, IU} ishall be the Fire - and worst indeed is that destination.} means, how terrible the consequences will be for the disbelievers, how evil a place to stay in and how awful a place to job jAi. jp ^jLX >t '-V *-V „'.*i ~y < /- ^ /> ^ », / / ^ rest! *&^& fis i&; j jztf szz4pjQ p: P&^} P 9&>*^ +*>. oj> sjy\$ o; ^Q. o^j j&\ yu ^s %&Jt l2- AiX "f, jiiVi £? ur, % *•&“p * #5^~i 46 ^ 41 *£ g&r ig M <L4 & PjPQ, \$ ££*• ^J6i v tk^r j(Vy^~i* ^ i*' ^ > >'f-' *,•' •" * < „ ^£t -* CH-j ! o'j y/t i58. O you who believe! Let your slaves and slave-girls, and those among you who have not come to the age of puberty ask your permission on three occasions : before the Fajr prayer, and

while you put off your clothes during the afternoon, and after the 'lshd' prayer. (These) three (times) are of privacy for you; other than these times there is no sin on you or on them to move about, attending to each other. Thus Allah makes clear the Ayat to you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 459. And when the children among you come to puberty, then let them (also) ask for permission, as those senior to them (in age) ask permission. Thus Allah makes clear His Ayat for you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 460. And the Qawa'id among women who do not hope for marriage, it is no sin on them if they discard their (outer) clothing in such a way as not to show their adornment. But to refrain is better for them. And Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knoier.} The Times when Servants and Young Children should seek Permission to enter These Ayat include a discussion of how people who are closely related should seek permission to enter upon one another. What was mentioned earlier in the Surah had to do with how unrelated people should seek permission to enter upon one another. Allah commanded the believers to ensure that their servants and their children who have not yet reached puberty should seek permission at three times: the first is before the Fajr prayer, because people are asleep in their beds at that time. 4and while you put off your clothes during the afternoon,} means, at the time of rest, because a man may be in a state of undress with his wife at that time. 4and after the 'lshd ' prayer.} because this is the time for sleep. Servants and children are commanded not to enter upon household members at these times, because it is feared that a man may be in an intimate situation with his wife and so on. Allah says:

i(These) three (times) are of privacy for you ; other than these times there is no sin on you or on them If they enter at a time other than these, there is no sin on you if you let them enter, and no sin on them if they see something at a time other than these times. They have been given permission to enter suddenly, because they are those who go around in the house, i.e., to serve you etc., and as such they may be forgiven for things that others will not be forgiven. Although this Ayah is quite clear and has not been abrogated, people hardly follow it, and 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas denounced the people for that. Abu

Dawud recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “Most of the people do not follow it, the Ayah that speaks about asking permission, but I tell my servant woman to seek permission to enter.” Abu Dawud said: ‘Ata’ also narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas commanded this. Ath-Thawri narrated that Musa bin Abi ‘A’ishah said, “I asked Ash-Shahi [about the Ayah]: H3£*ZZ ‘4 iLet your slaves and slave-girls ask your permission. He said, ‘It has not been abrogated.’ I said: ‘But the people do not do that.’ He said, ‘May Allah help them.’” [21 Then Allah says: it jZZ ‘jsZ (>£,) iAnd when the children among you come to puberty, then let them (also) ask for permission, as those senior to them (in age)} meaning: when the children who used to seek permission at the three times of privacy reach puberty, then they have to seek permission at all times, i.e., with regard to those who are non-relatives, and at times when a man may be in a state of intimacy with his wife, even if it is not one of the three times stated above. There is no Sin on Elderly Women if They do not wear a Cloak 'at Abu Dawud 5:377. At-Jabari 19:213.

4And the Qawa'id among women. Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said that these are the women who no longer think that they can bear children, 4who do not hope for marriage, meaning, they no longer have any desire for marriage, £lSi- 4it is no sin on them if they discard their (outer) clothing in such a way as not to show their adornment. meaning, they do not have to cover themselves in the same way that other women have to. Abu Dawud recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah: 4And tell the believing women to lower their gaze} [24 :31) was abrogated and an exception was made in the case of: 4V& S& -i\$K-f*^} 4the past childbearing among women who do not hope for marriage, .^*2 4it is no sin on them if they discard their (outer) clothing} Ibn Mas'ud said about (outer) clothing,, “The Jilbab or i'idd'.”*3 * A similar view was also narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, Ibn ‘Umar, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Ash-Sha‘tha’, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Az-Zuhri, Al-‘Awzal and others.*4 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :222 , At-Tabari 19:216. * Abu Dawud 4 :361 * At-Tabari 19:217. Here Jilb&b and Rida’ imply the same meaning; a large cloth used to surround the Khimdr and clothing of the woman. * At-Tabari 19:217,218.

iiin such a way as not to show their adornment. SaTd bin Jubayr said, “They should not make a wanton display of themselves by removing their outer garment so that their adornment may be seen.” 5£S4^ 4But to refrain is better for them.} means, not removing their outer garment, even though that is permissible for them, is better for them. iAnd Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knmver.} o' if y- if % y- yff f%^ yif f j' ') j' op j' f j' ffy j' j vy—1 j*' j" y=Qz .-^Ui j? jZJt- *ju jl Ld f^ ;jci! £ ^ pp p iO 4; j;<s&5yM ft dsfe*> i61 . There is no restriction on the blind, nor any restriction on the lame, nor any restriction on the sick, nor on yourselves, if you eat from your houses, or the houses of your fathers, or the houses of your mothers, or the Iwuses of your brothers, or the houses of your sisters, or the houses of your father's brothers, or the houses of your father's sisters, or the houses of your mother's brothers, or the houses of your mother's sisters, or (from that) ivhereof you hold keys, or (from the house) of a friend. No sin on you whether you eat together or apart. But when you enter the houses, greet one another with a greeting from Allah, blessed and good. Thus Allah makes clear the Ayat to you that you may understand.} Eating from One's Relatives' Houses

What is referred to here is the fact that they used to feel too

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3993–4001]

embarrassed to eat with the blind, because they could not see the food or where the best morsels were, so others might take the best pieces before they could. They felt too embarrassed to

eat with the lame because they could not sit comfortably, and their companions might take advantage of them, and they felt embarrassed to eat with the sick because they might not eat as much as others. So they were afraid to eat with them lest they were unfair to them in some way. Then Allah revealed this Ayah, granting them a dispensation in this matter. This was the view of Said bin Jubayr and Miqdam. 111 Ad-Dahhak said: "Before the Prophet's Mission, they used to feel too embarrassed and too proud to eat with these people, lest they might have to help them. So Allah revealed this Ayah." in or any restriction on the lame,} 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Mujahid said: "A man would take a blind, lame or sick person to the house of his brother or sister or aunt, and those disabled people would feel ashamed of that and say, 'they are taking us to other people's houses.' So this Ayah was revealed granting permission for that."13 As-Suddi said: "A man would enter the house of his father or brother or son, and the lady of the house would bring him some food, but he would refrain from eating because the master of the house was not there, so Allah revealed: iThere is no restriction on the blind...} It 3 && in or on yourselves, if you eat from your houses,} This is stated here although it is obvious, so that from this starting point the houses of others may be mentioned, and to make it clear that the ruling applies equally to what comes after. Sons' houses are included in this even though they are not mentioned by name, and this is used as evidence by those who regard the son's wealth as being like the father's wealth. In the Musnad and the Sunan, it is reported through several *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :223 , At-Tabari 19 :221 * At-Tabari 19:219. 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :64

routes that the Messenger of Allah said: «JjuS/ iuu j dJ{« "You and your wealth belong to your father.^ *£ j ior the houses of your fathers, or the houses of your mothers,} until His statement; t£ f} ior (from that) whereof you hold keys,} This is obvious, and this is used as evidence by those who think that it is obligatory for relatives to spend on one another. ior (from that) whereof you hold keys,} Said bin Jubayr and As- Suddi said, "This refers to a people's servants, whether a slave or otherwise. There is nothing wrong with them eating from the food that is stored with them, within reason." Az-Zuhri narrated from TJrwah that 'A'isha, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "The Muslims used to go out on military campaigns with the Messenger of Allah jg and they would give their keys to people they trusted and say, We permit you to eat whatever you need.' But they would say, It is not permissible for us to eat, they have given us permission reluctantly and we are only trustees.' Then Allah revealed: iHi- ^JiS JUr sqii \$i} ior (from that) whereof you hold keys}." ior (from the house) of a friend.} means, there is no sin on you if you eat from their houses, so long as you know that this does not upset them and they do not dislike it. [1] Ahmad 2:279, 204, 214, Ibn Majah 2:769. KashafAl-Astar3 :61 , 62

iNo sin on you whether you eat together or apart.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas concerning this Ayah, "When Allah revealed the Ayah: IikJa V £& 40 you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly [4:29], the Muslims said, 'Allah has forbidden us to eat up our property among ourselves unjustly, and food is the best of property, so it is not permissible for anyone among us to eat at the house of anyone else.' So the people stopped doing that. Then Allah revealed: iThere is no restriction on the blind,} until His statement; j} ior (from the house) of a friend.} A man would also feel embarrassed and would refrain from eating alone until someone else came along, but

Allah made the matter easier for them and said: {No sin on you whether you eat together or apart.} Qatadah said, "This was a clan of Banu Kinanah who during the Jahiliyyah thought that it was a source of shame for one of them to eat alone, to such an extent that a man might keep on driving his laden camel even though he was hungry, until he could find someone to eat and drink with him. Then Allah revealed: {No sin on you whether you eat together or apart.} So this was a dispensation from Allah, allowing people to eat either alone or with others, even though eating with others is more blessed and is better. m At-Tabari 19:224. 121 At-Tabari 19:224.

Imam Ahmad recorded from Wahshi bin Harb from his father from his grandfather that a man said to the Prophet ﷺ, "We eat but we do not feel satisfied." He said: {Perhaps you are eating separately. Eat together and mention the Name of Allah, and He will bless the food for you.} It was also recorded by Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah. 111 Ibn Majah also recorded that Salim reported from his father from 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah said: {Eat together and not separately, for the blessing is in being together.} [21] {But when you enter the houses, greet one another} Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri said, "This means greet one another with Salam." 13 Ibn Jurayj said: Abu Az-Zubayr said, "I heard Jabir bin 'Abdullah say, When you enter upon your family, greet them with a greeting from Allah, blessed and good." He said, I do not think it is anything but obligatory." Ibn Jurayj said: "And Ziyad said that Ibn Tawus used to say: When any one of you enters his house, let him say Salam." 4 Mujahid said: "And when you enter the Masjid, say: 'Peace be upon the Messenger of Allah'; when you enter upon your families, greet them with Salam; and when you enter a house in which there is nobody, say: 'As-Salamu 'Alayna wa 'Ala 'Ibad-Alladhi-Salihin (peace be upon us and upon the righteous servants of Allah).'" 15 This is what one is Ahmad 3 :501 , Abi Dawud 3764, Ibn Majah 3286. Ibn Majah 3287. Al-Baghawi 3 :358, At-Tabari 19 :226. 4 At-Tabari 19:225. 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :66

Allah commanded to do, and it has been narrated to us that the angels will return his greeting." 111 Allah says: {Allah makes clear the Ayat to you that you may understand.} When Allah mentioned what wise rulings and reasonable, well-constructed laws are contained in this Surah, He points out to His servants that He explains the Ayat to them clearly so that they may ponder them and understand their meanings. / > , / ' i , ' > , y I y - * " « y ^ / ^ ^ a j j » y J f L - A < f * > J * < s ^ t l i ^ f * * \ y \ f = * * * i i y * j j • " • i * • j l j o j l i p 4 ^ - ' 4) * ^ — " 44 ~ y H i d i t j ' y . • » : » » • ; - i f i i f » T - > • j y - * * » ' - d _ 4 * a ' p - i 1 > (4 ^ i < 62. The believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger; and what they are with him on some common matter, they go not away until they have asked his permission. Verily, those who ask your permission, those are they who (really) believe in Allah and His Messenger. So if they ask your permission for some affairs of theirs, give permission to whom you will of them, and ask Allah for their forgiveness. Truly, m Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :228

Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful . Asking Permission to leave when They are doing something together This is another matter of etiquette to which Allah has guided His believing servants. Just as He commanded them to seek permission when entering, He also commanded them to seek permission when leaving, especially when they are doing something together with the Messenger ﷺ, such as the

Friday, 'Id, or congregational prayers, or a meeting for the purpose of consultation and so on. Allah commanded them not to leave him in these situations until they had asked his permission. If they did this, then they were of the true believers. Then Allah commanded His Messenger ﷺ to give permission when someone asked for it, if he wanted to. He said: *“If you give permission to whom you will of them, and ask Allah for their forgiveness.”* Abu Dawud reported that Abu Hurayrah said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *‘When any of you joins a gathering, let him say **Salam**, and when he wants to leave, let him say **Salam**. The former is not more important than the latter. This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasai; At-Tirmidhi said: “It is a Hasan Hadith,”*²¹ *“Do not make the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one of another. Allah knows those of you who slip away under shelter. And let those beware who oppose the Messenger’s ﷺ.”* Abu Dawud 5:386. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :485 , An-Nasai in Al-Kubra 6 :100

commandment, lest some Fitnah should befall them or a painful torment be inflicted on them.} The Etiquette of addressing the Prophet **Ad-Dahhak** said, reporting from Ibn ‘Abbas: “They used to say, ‘O Muhammad,’ or ‘O Abu Al-Qasim,’ but Allah forbade them to do that, as a sign of respect towards His Prophet ﷺ, and told them to say, ‘O Prophet of Allah,’ ‘O Messenger of Allah.’ This was also the view of Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr.”² Qatadah said: “Allah commanded that His Prophet ﷺ should be treated with respect and honor, and that he should be a leader.”³ Muqatil said concerning the Ayah: *“Do not make the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one of another.”* {“When you address him, do not say, ‘O Muhammad,’ or ‘O son of ‘Abdullah’; rather honor him and say, ‘O Prophet of Allah,’ or, ‘O Messenger of Allah.’”⁴—“*Do not make the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one of another.*”} A second view concerning the meaning of the Ayah is that it means ‘do not think that if he prays against you it is like when anyone else prays against you, because his prayers will be answered; so beware lest he prays against you and you will be doomed.’ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this from Ibn ‘Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and ‘Atiyyah Al-Awfi. And Allah knows best.”⁴ *“Do not make the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one of another.”* {Allah knows those of you who slip away under shelter.} Muqatil bin Hayyan said, “This refers to the hypocrites who used to find it too difficult to listen to the Khutbah on Fridays, so they would hide behind some of the Companions of **Ad-DurrAl-Manthur** 6 :230 [2] At-Jabari 19:230. Al-Tabari 19:230. 141 At-Tabari 19:230.

133 Surah 24. An-Nur (63) (Part-18) Muhammad ﷺ and sneak out of the Masjid. It was not proper for a man to leave on Fridays once the Khutbah began, unless he had permission from the Prophet ﷺ. If one of them wanted to leave, he would make a gesture to the Prophet ﷺ with his finger, and the Prophet ﷺ would give permission without the man speaking. This is because if the Prophet ﷺ was giving the Khutbah and a man spoke, it would invalidate his Friday prayer.” As-Suddi said, “If they were with him for a congregational prayer, they would hide behind one another so that he could not see them.”

The Prohibition of going against the Messenger’s

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4001–4003]

Commandment i And let those beware who oppose the Messenger’s commandment^ This means going against the commandment of the Prophet ﷺ, which is his way, methodology and Sunnah. All words and deeds will be measured against his words and deeds; those that are in accordance with his words and

deeds will be accepted, and whatever does not match up will be rejected, no matter who the person is who said and did them. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs and elsewhere that the Messenger of Allah jg said: A* 4* lA y** Jt* j*1 «Whoever does a deed that is not in accordance with this matter of ours will have it rejected .»'2 ' meaning, let those beware who go against the Shan'ah of the Messenger sg, in secret and in the open, jLi' •>' > tv trM> o'r ilest some Fitnah should befall them}, i.e., lest some disbelief or hypocrisy or innovation enter their hearts. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :23 1 121 Fath Al-Bari4 : 416 , Muslim 3 :1343

iAnd put your trust until His saying; in the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful,} 4Verily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the AU-Knoiver [26:217-220]. IjjJi 'll Vj yl.Ji Oi *it 4 ,>* Vj 4 Vj u>jVi ^_j)ji ^ 4->“ *ri 4;|oJw# 4 ^ 'J3% 4Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed but We are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord; (even) the weight of a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not

what is less than that or what is greater than that but is in a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4003–4004]

Clear Record .} [10:61] 4o3" £^ -A} 4Is then He Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned?} [13:33] He sees all that His servants do, good and evil alike. And Allah says. /S , *t a , Uj U JUj >-\$jU > <jrw j ' 4Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments, He knows what they conceal and what they reveal>] 1 1:5). <yj jji)' "A A “A? 4It is the same (to Him) ivhether any ofyou conceals his speech or declares it openly [13:10]. 4 jf ^V-Ay—A} %>j l*i)j Jc- V* 4>jV' . (ijU 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} [11:6] 4 i*? yA 4 crff-% A'J^ 4 A 4And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them

Surah 25: Al-Furqan

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Furqan

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4005–4021]

(Chapter - 25) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Blessed be He Who sent down (Nazzala) the criterion to His servant that he may be a warner to all nations.} 42. He to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Who has begotten no son and for Whom there is no partner in the dominion. He has created everything, and has measured it exactly according to its due measurements.} Blessed be Allah Here Allah praises Himself for the Noble Qur'an He has revealed to His noble Messenger sﷺ. This is like the Ayat liaS d; Jx3 <4 \$ &.% :M &\$4 ' k y—lMj AjJkI All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has sent down to His servant the Book, and has not placed therein any crookedness. (He has made it) straight to give warning of a severe punishment from Him, and to give glad tidings to the believers, who do righteous deeds...} [18:1-2] Here Allah says: , , v Am} 4Blessed be He.} The verbal form used here implies an ongoing, permanent, eternal blessing. £4^

iWho sent down the criterion The verb Nazzala is a form which implies something done a great deal and often. This is like the Ayah: the Book which He (Nazzala) sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He (Anzala) sent down to those before (him)} (4:136). Each of the previous Books was sent down at one time, but the Qur'an was revealed gradually, in stages, Ayat after Ayat, rulings after rulings, Surahs after Surahs. This is more eloquent and indicative of greater care for the one to whom it is revealed, as Allah says later in this Surah: seat&\$y \&r yr iAnd those who disbelieve say: "Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once?" Thus, that We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages. And no example or similihide do they bring, but We reveal to you the truth, and the better explanation thereof.} (25:32-33) This Surah was named Al-Furqan, because it is the criterion that decides between truth and falsehood, guidance and misguidance, right and wrong, lawful and unlawful. \$} 4to His servant} This description is one of praise and commendation, because here Allah is connecting him to Him- self, describing him as His servant. Allah also described him in this manner when referring to the noblest of events, the Night of the Isra ', as He said: 4% i£.1 8\$^} 4Glorified be He Who took His servant for a journey by night} Allah also described him in this way when He described how he stood and called to Him: yi* ju l \$j}

139Surah 25. Al-Furqan (1 - 2) (Part-18 iAnd when the servant of Allah stood up invoking Him in prayer they (the Jinn) just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking one over the other (in order to listen to the Prophet's recitation).} (72:19) This description is also used here when Allah describes how the Book is revealed to him and how the angel comes down to him: > ,, ii£i Jj iBlessed be He Who sent

down the criterion to His servant that he may be a warmer to all nations.} CyjJLuU ofi).} it that he may be a warmer to all nations.} means, he alone has been blessed with this great, detailed, clear Book which, 4> f&r It dtj? <y. 3^2' tJf. y} 4Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by tire All-Wise, Worthy of all praise (Allah).} (41:42) The One Who made it the mighty criterion, singled him out to convey it to those who seek the shade of trees and to those who live on the land (i.e., to all of mankind, nomad and settled alike), as the Prophet sg said: «/ have been sent to the red and the black .u111 And he said: 1 JL»-t C ..1at-i «I have been given five things which no Prophet before me was given. Among them he mentioned: J ILlj liu- JI J-ii; *[Before me] a Prophet was sent only to his own people, but I have been sent to all ofmankind . 111 Ahmad 5:145. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 : 634.

140 Tafstr Ibn Kathir And Allah says: iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah..." } (7:158), meaning, the One Who has sent me is the Sovereign of the heaven and the earth, who merely says to a thing "Be!" and it is. He is the one who gives life and causes death. Allah says here: \$He to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Who has begotten no son andfor Whom there is no partner in the dominion.} Allah states that He is above having any offspring or partner. Then He tells us: r tMimz i*v ^ villi' 4— (j' lityLUi jLLg ili/j' Cp oli==a \) bxx-tjScLEJLiyl^" iAJii A)J-i» J£= vjii-y <He has created everything, and has measured it exactly according to its due measurements.} meaning, everything apart from Him is created and subject to Him. He is the Creator, Lord, Master and God of all things, and everything is subject to His dominion, control and power. i'& ^ 4 IJIC^ a; !42>

141Surah 25. Al-Furqdn (3) (Part-18 43. Yet they have taken besides Him other gods who created nothing but are themselves created, and possess neither harm nor benefit for themselves, and possess no power (of causing) death, nor (ofgiving) life, nor of raising the dead.) The Foolishness ofthe Idolators Allah tells us of the ignorance of the idolators in taking other gods instead of Allah, the Creator of all things, the One Who controls the affairs of all things; whatever He wills happens and whatever He does not will does not happen. In spite of that, they still worshipped others besides Him, idols who could not even create the wing of a gnat, but were themselves created. They could neither do harm nor bring benefit to themselves, so how could they do anything for their worshippers? iand possess no poiver (of causing) death, nor (of giving) life, nor of raising the dead.) means, they could not do any of that at all; that power belongs only to Allah, Who is the One Who gives life and death, and is the One Who will bring all people, the first and the last, back to life on the Day of Resurrection. 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as (the creation and resurrection of) a single person) (31:28). This is like the Ayat, \$ SU-S 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.) (54:50) 4But it will be only a single ZajrahP When behold, theyfind themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.) (79:13-14) m See the TafSrof Surat As-Saffat (37 : 19]

ilt will be a single Zajrah, and behold, they will be staring!} (37:19) Vi j; 4 4/f will be but a single Sayhah, so behold they will all be brought up before Us!} (36:53). He is Allah besides Whom there is no other God and besides Whom there is no other Lord. No one should be worshipped except Him because whatever He wills happens and whatever he does not will does not happen. He has no offspring nor progenitor, nor equal nor likeness nor rival nor peer. He is the One, the Self-Sufficient Master,

Whom all creatures need, He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none co-equal or comparable unto Him. l*U» oii pif-T - i. ur-w' 4 ol^=» ojiVb ^ 5^' (*Lj“ 44. Those who disbelieve say: “This is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him in it.” In fact, they have produced an unjust wrong and a lie.} 45. And they say: “Tales of the ancients which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon.”} 46. Say: “It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.”} What the Disbelievers said about the Qur’an Allah tells us about the foolishness of the disbelievers’ ignorant minds, when they said about the Qur’an: % Til 11} 4This is nothing but a lie}, meaning an untruth. 4that he has invented,} meaning the Prophet jg.

243Surah 25. Al-Furqdn (4 - 6) (Part-18) pj» iand others have helped him in it.} means, he asked other people to help him compile it. So Allah said: i<i&& j%&} iln fact, they have produced an unjust wrong and a lie.} meaning, they are the ones who are telling a lie, and they know that it is false, for their own souls know that what they are claiming is not true. «V.yi£J Vf \$%} iAnd they say: “Tales of the ancients which he has written down...”} meaning, the ancients wrote them down, and he has copied it. 4*4*& iand they are dictated to him} means, they are read or recited to him. imorning and afternoon.} at the beginning and end of the day. Because this idea is so foolish and is so patently false, everyone knows that it is not true. It is known through Mutawatir reports and is a common fact that Muhammad the Messenger of Allah jg never learned to read or write, either at the beginning or the end of his life. He grew up among them for approximately forty years, from the time he was born until the time when his mission began. They knew all about him, and about his honest and sound character and how he would never lie or do anything immoral or bad. They even used to call him Al-Amin (the Trustworthy One) from a young age, until his mission began, because they saw how truthful and honest he was. When Allah honored him with that which He honored him, they declared their enmity towards him and came up with all these accusations which any reasonable person would know he was innocent of. They were not sure what to accuse him of. Sometimes they said that he was a sorcerer, at other times they would say he was a poet, or crazy, or a liar. So Allah said:

"S Su ijiV jfcViJ \£>SZ iSee what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way.} (17 :48) In response to their stubbornness, Allah says here: j yp pCZ isji\ iijit 4Say : "It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth".} meaning, He has revealed the Qur’an which includes true information about the earlier and later generations, information which concurs with the realities of the past and future. i'ypPZ jM} AWho blows the secret means, Allah is the One Who knows the unseen in the heavens and on the earth; He knows their secrets just as He knows what is visible therein. jyii ul^=» ATruly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is an invitation to them to repent and turn back to Allah, telling them that His mercy is vast and His patience is immense. Whoever repents to Him, He accepts his repentance. Despite all their lies, immorality, falsehood, disbelief and stubbornness, and saying what they said about the Messenger SH and the Qur’an, He still invites them to repent and give up their sin, and to come to Islam and true guidance. This is like the Ayat \$ VS U kV 'jiu yj\ 13)> sJl \$3 \£T <£,Jf VVjOX iV iSurely, disbelievers are those who said: "Allah is the third of the three." But there is no god but One God. And if they cease not from what they say, verily, a painful torment will befall on the disbelievers among them. Will they not turn with repentance to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-

145 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (7 - 14) (Part-18 Forgiving, Most Merciful.) (5:73- 74) SssSB ^ ii ?^ v'j*\$ 'fvr iVerily, those who put into trial the believing men and believing women, and then do not him in repentance, then they will have the torment of Hell, and they will have the punishment of the burning Fire.) (85:10) Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: "Look at this kindness and generosity! They killed His friends and He is calling them to repentance and mercy." \ZLjr \jX\ Uijo Ci cy, lyii ^ iy-j C(o-iZ 47. And they say: "Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?"\$

146 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 48. "Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?" And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched."} 49. See how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray, and they cannot find a path.} 410. Blessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that - Gardens under which rivers flow and will assign you palaces.} 411. Nay, they deny the Hour, and for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire.} 412. When it sees them from a far place, they will hear its raging and its roaring.} 413. And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction.} 414. Exclaim not today for one destruction, but exclaim for many destructions.} What the Disbelievers said about the Messenger refutation of Their Words, and Their ultimate Destiny Allah tells us about the disbelievers' stubborn resistance to and rejection of the truth, with no proof or evidence for doing so. Their excuse was, as they said: 4.X-*k)t J\fJJS Oc* At} 4Why does this Messenger eat food,} meaning, 'as we eat, and why does he need food as we need it?' 4and walk about in the markets.} means, he walks around and goes there often seeking to trade and earn a living. 4Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?} They were saying: why doesn't an angel come down to him from Allah, to be a witness that what he is claiming is true? This is like when FiraVn said:

^ ^ 4mJL* t_-4i <TIA% then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him, or angels sent along with him?"} (43:53). These people had a similar mentality and said the same kind of thing. They said: 4i& - \} 40r (why) has not a treasure been granted to him?} meaning, treasure that he could spend on his needs and wants. V-A uVj^)-} ior why 1ms he not a garden whereof he may eat?} meaning, a garden that would go with him wherever he went. All of this is easy for Allah, but He had a reason for not doing any of these things, and with Him is the perfect proof and argument. ji j\^j} iAnd the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched."} Allah said: // /.{ »" I iy/ ^ .> ^ 4'jLoi JWV1 jjj Jtif iSee how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray,} meaning, they accused you and belied you when they said that you were a sorcerer or bewitched or crazy or a liar or a poet, but all of these are false ideas. Everyone who has the slightest understanding will recognize that they are lying. Allah says: iso they have gone astray} from the path of guidance. iand they cannot find a path.} Everyone who steps outside of the way of truth and guidance has gone astray, no matter what direction he takes, because the truth is one and its methodology is unified, parts of it confirming other parts. Then Allah tells His Prophet that if He willed, He could

bestow on him in this world something far better than what they were saying. He said: (y (jy- ill! ^ oj. XSJ& iBlessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that...} Mujahid said, "This means in this world." And he said: "The Quraysh used to call every house that was made of stone a

'palace', whether it was large or small."111 \y'& j.^ iNay, they deny the Hour,} means, they say this in stubborn disbelief, not because they are seeking insight and guidance, but because their disbelief in the Day of Resurrection makes them say what they say. 4And We have prepared} means, We have made ready,' MdC v-i6*» J4} ifor those who deny the Hour, aflaming Fire.} means, an unbearably hot and painful torment in the fire of Hell. iWhen it sees them} means, when Hell sees them, ifrom a far place,} means from the place of gathering (on the Day of Resurrection), U [y^} ithey will hear its raging and its roaring.} means, (it will make those sounds) out of hatred towards them. This is like the Ayah, }When they are cast therein, they will hear the (terrible) m At-Tabari 19:243.

149Surah 25. Al-Furqan (7 - 14) (Part-18) drawing in of its breath as it blazes forth. It almost bursts up withfury» (67:7-8), which means that parts of it almost separate from other parts because of its intense hatred towards those who disbelieved in Allah. Imam Abu Ja"far bin Jarir narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said: "A man will be dragged towards Hell, which will be expanding and contracting, and Ar-Rahman will say to it: What is the matter with you?' It will say: He is seeking refuge from me.' So Allah will say, *Let My servant go.' Another man will be dragged towards Hell and he will say, 'O Lord, I never expected this from You.' Allah will say, What did you expect?' The man will say, 1 expected that Your mercy would be great enough to include me.' So Allah will say, "Let My servant go.' Another man will be dragged towards Hell, and Hell will bray at him like a donkey braying at barley. Then it will give a moan that will instill fear in everyone."11 ' Its chain of narrators is Sahth. 4U& U 4they will hear its raging and its roaring> 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that TJbayd bin TJmayr said: "Hell will utter a moan such that there will be no angel who is close to Allah and no Prophet sent to mankind, but he will fall on his face, shaking all over. Even Ibrahim, peace be upon him, will fall to his knees and say: 'O Lord, I do not ask You for salvation this Day except for myself.' '^2 ' ULi Ijl& lyjl 4And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, Qatadah narrated from Abu Ayyub that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said: "Like the point of a spear, i.e., in its narrowness."13' At-Tabari 9:370. 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :67 I3 ' Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6:240, Az-Zuhd by Ibn Al-Mubarak in Az- Zawa'id 86.

whom He has shown His favor. He says: \$It is a upon your Lord a Wa'dan Mas'fda) meaning, it must inevitably come to pass. Abu Jafar bin Jarir reported from some of the scholars of the Arabic language that the words iWa'dan Mas'iila) mean: a binding pledge. In this Surah Allah mentions Hell, then refers to the situation of the people of Paradise. This is similar to the passage in Surat As-Saffat where Allah mentions the status of the people of Paradise, with its beauty and joy, then He says: SJifS JjX'y P\$ oj ^ ^ :;ojs3f 4/s that better entertainment or the tree ofZaqqim? Tndy, We have made it a trial for the wrongdoers. Verily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hellfire, The shoots of its fruit stalks are like the heads ofShaydtin. Tndy, they will eat thereof and fill their bellies therewith . Then on the top of tluit they will be given boiling water to drink so that it becomes a mixture. Then thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell. Verily, they found their fathers on the wrong path. So they hastened in theirfootsteps!) (37:62-70) •> . ,/ W' . > >*•* ,// ••>>. /r//v » 4W U>> \AJ n C\$J JA jicj ^ u U ijJli lIS \1j xii 1^5 ^^ 4^4^= iii pUL' Sfj lip 427. And on the Day when He will gather them togetlier and that which they worship besides Allah. He will say: 'Was it you who tnisled these My servants or did they stray from the At-Tabari 19:247.

152 Tafstr Ibn Kathir path?"} 418. They will say: "Glorified be You! It was not for us to take any Awliya' besides You, but You gave them and their fathers comfort till they forgot the warning, and became a lost people."} 419. Thus they will deny you in what you say; then you can neither avert nor find help. And whoever among you does wrong, We shall make him taste a great torment.} The gods of the idolators will disown them on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about what will happen on the Day of Resurrection, when those whom the idolators used to worship instead of Allah, angels and others, will rebuke them. Allah says: <2 / AA »' OJJ ot •AAA •/ <• •**V fjjf 4And on the Day when He will gather them together and that which they worship besides Allah.} Mujahid said, "This means Isa, TJzayr and the angels. 43j& jaw Jjit 4He will say: "Was it you who misled these My servants...?"} Allah will say to those who were worshipped: T)id you call these people to worship you instead of Me, or was it their own idea to worship you, without any call to that on your part?' This is like the Ayah, JB jif ojilil1 Sis 'if ts-ilr-l *f)} 4 £2 4 S4 £\$ 3 4 c£&£ 4,h jS3% 4And when Allah will say : "O 'Isa, son of Maryam! Did you say unto men : 'Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?' " He will say: "Glory be to You! It was not far from me to say what I had no right (to say). Had I said such a thing, You m At-Tabari 19:247.

153 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (15 - 19) (Part-18) would surely have known it. You know what is in my inner self though I do not know what is in Yours ; truly, You, only You, are the All-Knower of all that is hidden. Never did I say to them aught except what You did command me to say."} (5:116-117) Describing how those who were worshipped will respond on

the Day of Resurrection, Allah says:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4021–4043]

Si os 5*2 o' ft C 4They will say : "Glorified be You! It was not for us to take (Nattakhidh) any Awliyd' besides You..."} Most of the scholars recite a Fathah on the Nun of the word Nattakhidh in His saying: 4'Qi it ot '& 4" ...for us to take (Nattakhidh) any Awliyd' besides You,"} meaning, 'it is not right for any created being, neither us nor them, to worship anyone except You; we did not call them to do that, but they did it of their own accord, without us telling them to do it or accepting what they did. We are innocent of them and their worship.' This is like the Ayah, 4And (remember) the Day when He will gather them all together, then He will say to the angels : "Was it you that these people used to worship?" They (the angels) will say: "Glorified be You!"} (34:40-41) Other scholars understand this phrase to mean: 'it is not proper for us to take anyone except You as protectors or helpers (Awliyd),' meaning, "it is not proper for anyone to worship us, for we are Your servants and in need of You.' This meaning is close to the first. 4but You gave them and their fathers comfort} means, "You made such a long period of time pass that they forgot the Reminder, i.e., they forgot what had been sent down to them through the Messengers, calling them to worship You alone with no partner or associate.'

<Q%WS> iand became a lost people.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means, they were destroyed."*^ Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Malik narrated from Az-Zuhri: "There was no good in them."*2 ! And Allah says: iThus they will deny you because of what you say;} meaning, "those whom you used to worship besides Allah will show you to be liars in your claims that they were your helpers and protectors bringing you closer to Allah.' This is like the Ayah jc- |Uj sy Ji yi V iy ji> Ly }££ J** j-J yj} 4And who is more astray

than one who calls on besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are unaware of their calls to them . And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.} (46:5-6) 4then you can neither avert nor find help.} means: they will not be able to avert the punishment from themselves, nor will they be able to help themselves. i.^==*£ 4^2 4And ivhoever among you does wrong,} means by associating others in worship with Allah, li'-if- *jx} }We shall make him taste a great torment.} 4 iJs'Li^ S; iXi ~£j} At-T*bari 19:248. 121 At-Ti.bari 19:248.

155 Surah 25. Al-Furqdn (20) (Part-18 420. And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets. And We have made some of you as a trial for others; will you have patience? And your Lord is Ever All-Seer.} All of the Previous Messengers were Human Allah tells us about the previous Messengers He sent: they all used to eat food needing the nourishment in it. They used to go around in the marketplaces seeking to engage in trade and earn a livelihood. This should not, however, affect their status as Messengers, for Allah gave them good characteristics and caused them to speak fine words and do noble deeds, and gave them miracles and clear proofs, from which any person with sound insight may see the confirmation that what they brought from Allah was true. This Ayah is similar to the Ayat, oj zj4^ •§[oft %} iAnd We sent not before you any but men unto wlwm We revealed, from among the people of townships} (12:109). 4fU£l} oj 'jui p (••>«• Uj} iAnd We did not create them bodies that ate not food} (21:8). iAnd We have made some of you as a trial for others; will you have patience?} means, *We test some of you by means of others, so that We may see who will be obedient and who will be disobedient.' Allah says: iwill you have patience? And your Lord is Ever All-Seer.} meaning. He knows who deserves to receive revelation, as Allah says elsewhere: iAllah knows best with whom to place His Message} (6:124). And He knows who deserves to be guided to the Message with which He sent them, and who does not deserve to be guided.

156 Tafair Von Kathir iAnd We have made some of you as a trial for others. Will you have patience Muhammad bin Ishaq said: Allah is saying, "If I had willed that the world be such that no one would oppose My Messengers, I could have made it so, but I wanted to test My servants by means of them."111 In Sahih Muslim it is narrated from 'Iyad bin HimSr that the Messenger of Allah jg said: : 5il Jyu} lAllah says "I will test you and test others by means of you."»|2 ' In the Sahih it is recorded that he 0, was given the choice between being a Prophet and king, or being a servant and Messenger, and he chose to be a servant and Messenger. jjl Ly VJI b#jJ V Jij^ i%>.? ^ lift [j> j i-ek ^r* In i>L* £ dV ^ £ 421 . And those who expect not a meeting with Us said: "Why At-Tabari 19:377 Muslim 2865

are not the angels sent down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride. 422 . On the Day they will see the angels - no good news will there be for the criminals that day. And they will say: "Hijran Mahjura."} 423. And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} 424. The dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose. The Stubbornness of the Disbelievers Allah describes how stubborn the disbelievers were in their disbelief when they said: iWhy are not the angels sent down to us,} meaning, 'so that we may see them with our own eyes and they may tell us that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.' This is like when they said: 4^4 'A\$ 4or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face} (17:92). Hence they also

said: t 4&>& ior why do we not see our Lord?} Allah said: 4(4& xjt fH} ilndeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride.) And Allah says: }And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them ...} (6: 1 1 1)

iVerily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah," and then they stand firm, on them the angels will descend (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the good news of Paradise which you have been promised! We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have what your souls desire, and therein you shall have what you ask for. Entertainment from, the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} (41:30-32) According to an authentic Hadith narrated from Al-Bara' bin 'Azib, the angels say to the believer's soul (at the time of death): "Come out, O good soul in a good body, as you were dwelling in it. Come out to rest and pleasant fragrances and a Lord Who is not angry." 1 11 Other scholars said that the Ayah: iOn the Day they will see the angels - no good neios} refers to the Day of Resurrection. This was the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others. But there is no contradiction between these two views, because on both of these days - the day of death and the Day of Resurrection - the angels will appear to the believers and disbelievers, and they will give glad tidings of divine mercy and pleasure to the believers, while they will give the disbelievers news that will bring regret and sorrow, so there will be no glad tidings for the evildoers and criminals on that Day. iAnd they (angels) will say: "Hijran Malijura."} The angels will say to the disbelievers: 'success is forbidden to you this day.' The basic meaning of Al-Hijr is preventing or prohibition, hence the word is used in the phrase "Hajara Al- m Muslim 4 :2202

260 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Qadi Ala Fulan" (or, "The judge prohibited so and so.") when he forbids him to dispose of his wealth in cases of bankruptcy, folly, being underage, etc. The name of Al-Hijr (the low semicircular wall near the Ka'bah) is also derived from this root, because it prevents people from Tawaf inside it, since they have to go behind it. The mind is also called Al-Hijr, because it prevents a person from indulging in things that do not befit him. In conclusion, the pronoun in the phrase. 4And they will say} refers to the angels. This was the view of Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, 'Atiyyah Al-'Awfi, 'Ata' Al- Khurasani, Khusayf and others; it was also the view favored by Ibn Jarir. 111 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Jurayj said that this referred to the words of the idolaters. 121 40n the Day they will see the angels} means, they will seek refuge from the angels. This is because when disaster and hardship struck, the Arabs would say: 4"Hijran Malijura."} Although there is a point to what Ibn Jurayj said, from the context it is unlikely that this is what was meant, and the majority of scholars said something different. it |As* £ J', 4And We shall him to whatever deeds they did,} This refers to the Day of Resurrection, when Allah will bring mankind to account for their deeds, good and bad alike. Allah tells us that the deeds which these idolaters thought would bring them salvation will be of no avail to them, because they were not in accordance with the Sharpah or Laws of Allah, whether in terms of sincere intention or in terms of following the Laws set out by Allah. Every deed that is neither sincere nor in accordance with the Laws of Allah is futile, and the 111 At-Tabari 19 :256, Al-MuharrarAl-Wajtz 4 :206. 121 At-Tabari 19:254.

161Surah 25. Al-Furqan (21 - 24) (Part-19 deeds of the disbelievers are either one or the other, or they may include both, in which case they are even less likely to be accepted. Allah says: iAnd We shall him to xuhatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scatteredfloating particles of dust.}

Sufyan Ath-Thawri, narrated from Abu Ishaq, from Al-Harith that 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on Allah's saying: and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust (Habit').} "The rays of the sun when they pass through a small aperture." A similar view was also narrated through a different chain of narrators from 'Ali, and something similar was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak and others.* 11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "This refers to the rays coming through a small window, and if anyone tries to grasp them, he cannot."*21 Abu Al-Ahwas narrated from Abu Ishaq from Al-Harith that 'Ali said: "Haba refers to the dust raised by animals." A similar view was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas and Ad-Dahhak, and this was also said by 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. is scattered floating particles of dust (Haba').} Qatadah said: "Have you not seen dry trees when they are blown by the wind? This refers to those leaves."*31 It was narrated that Ya'la bin 'Ubayd said: "Ashes or dust when it is stirred up by the wind." In conclusion, all of these views are pointing out that the deeds of the disbelievers will be like some worthless scattered thing, and will be of no avail to them whatsoever. As Allah says: At-Jabari 19:257 258. * At-Tabari 19:257. * At-Tabari 19:258.

162 Tafstr Ibn KathTr 4& *Z0 Ig. !E2T &} 4The parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously (14:18). 4is>% V \pa bM 40 you who believe! Do not render in vain your charity by reminders of your generosity or by injury,} until His saying: iThey are not able to do anything with what they Ivxve earned> (2:264). 4\ki iJ4 ji ;:ts; & £\$ £&4X^ i;^=. 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing (24:39). The Abode of the People of Paradise Allah says: / ' . / ' i •C/' • i <5 • f • t \ } The dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. <\$5#* jU jisif 4^-1 fen 4PIS^4^ 4Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful} (59:20). That is because the people of Paradise will ascend to lofty degrees and secure dwellings, so they will be in a place of safety, beauty and goodness, fcjj 4Abiding therein - excellent it is as an abode, and as a place to rest in.} (25:76) The people of Hell will go down to the lowest levels and

continual regret, with all kinds of punishments and torments. ^ ,yi liLLij iEvil indeed it (Hell) is as an abode and as a place to rest in.>(25:66) means, how evil a dwelling place to look at, and how evil an abode in which to stay. Allah says: li3* tSLi% iXX iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose meaning, in return for what they have done of acceptable deeds, they will attain what they will attain and reach the status they will reach, in contrast to the people of Hell, who will not have even one deed to their credit that would qualify them to enter Paradise and be saved from the Fire. Allah points out the situation of the blessed in contrast to that of the doomed, who will not enjoy any goodness at all. Said bin Jubayr said: "Allah will finish the Judgement halfway through the Day, and the people of Paradise will take their mid day rest in Paradise and the people of Hell in Hell. Allah says: 5 •/ iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose. Ikrimah said, "I know the time when the people of Paradise will enter Paradise and the people of Hell will enter Hell. It is the time which in this world is the time when the late forenoon starts and people go back to their families to take a siesta. The people of Hell will go to Hell, but the people of Paradise will be taken to Paradise and will have their siesta in

Paradise, and they will be fed the liver of a whale and they will all eat their fill. This is what Allah says: itfi&y •Hrs. iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.^

164 Tafslr Ibn Kathir CiXjet gfoj Sy*^ j* ,j-“i f_W tiiCL 31 i£ £=>% £ J3 13 ti# i*i ^ ^iMM 4&~» 425. And (remember) the Day when the heaven shall be rent asunder with clouds, and the angels will be sent down, with a grand descending .) 426. The sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty) of the Most Gracious, and it will be a hard Day for the disbelievers .) 427. And (remember) the Day when the wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say: "Oh! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger.") 428. "Ah! Woe to me! Would that I had never taken so-and-so as an intimate friend!") 429. "He indeed led me astray from the Reminder after it had come to me. And Shaytan is to man ever a deserter.") The Terrors of the Day of Resurrection, and how the Wrongdoers will wish that They had taken a Path with the Messenger sg Here Allah tells us about the terror of the Day of Resurrection and the tremendous events that will happen, including the splitting of heavens when they are pierced by the clouds, that is the shadow of the magnificent light which dazzles all sight. The angels of heaven will come down on that Day and surround all creatures at the place of gathering, then the Lord, may He be blessed and exalted, will come to pass judgement. Mujahid said, "This is as Allah says: 4i^ij j>& 4*&£ 4Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them in the shadows of the clouds and the angels?)" (2:210)m IM At-Tabari 19:260.

265 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (25 - 29) {Part-19} iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty) of the Most Gracious,} This is like the Ayah, iWhose is the kingdom this Day? : It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistable!} (40:16) In the Sahih it says: 'J fj/j#ji 'JV3 1 41)1 O Vi hjs 'jS ocin iji iio lm «Allah, may He be exalted, will fold up the heavens in His Right Hand, and will take the earths in His other Hand, then He will say: "I am the Sovereign, I am the Judge. Where are the kings of the earth? Where are the tyrants? Where are the arrogant <> ^6} iand it will be a hard Day for the disbelievers .} means it will be very difficult, because it will be the Day of justice and the decisive judgement, as Allah says: iTruly, that Day will be a hard Day - Far from easy for the disbelievers (74:9-10). This is how the disbelievers will be on the Day of Resurrection. As for the believers, Allah says: i'fkJti pi *> 4The greatest terror will not grieve them.} ^ olkf jjSTj *Ji' jc Jj; fjj} iAnd (remember) the Day when the wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say : "O! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger."} Here Allah tells us of the regret felt by the wrongdoer who |i| FathAl-B&ri 1 1 :379 , Muslim 4 :2148

167 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (30 - 31) (Part-19 430. And the Messenger will say: "O my Lord! Verily, my people deserted this Qur'an."} 431 . Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals. But sufficient is your Lord as a Guide and Helper.} The Messenger^ will complain against His Opponents Allah tells how His Messenger and Prophet Muhammad will say: "O my Lord! Verily, my people deserted this Qur'an." The idolaters would not listen to the Qur'an, as Allah says: 4#j, Uil V cjiS' iAnd those who disbelieve say: "Listen not to this Qur'an, and make noise in the midst of it."} (41:26). When he would recite Qur'an to them, they would talk nonsense or speak about something else, so that they would not hear it. This is a form of forsaking it and rejecting it, and not believing in it is the same as forsaking it, and not pondering its meanings and trying to understand it is the same as forsaking it, and not acting upon it and following its commandments and heeding its prohibitions is the

same as forsaking it, and turning away from it in favor of poetry or other words or songs or idle talk or some other way is the same as forsaking it. We ask Allah, the Most Generous, the Bestower of bounty, the One Who is able to do what He wills, to keep us safe from doing that which earns His wrath and to use us to do that which will earn His pleasure of preserving and understanding His Book, following its commandments night and day in the manner which He loves and which pleases Him, for He is Generous and Kind. {Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.} means, 'just as there is for you, O Muhammad, those people who scorned the Qur'an, so in all the previous nations did Allah make for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals, who called people to their misguidance and disbelief,' as Allah says:

g p, OZ && } oii} c&Q- iAttd so We have appointed for every Pro- phet enemies - Shaydtfn among mankind and Jinn as stated in these two Ayat. (6:112) Allah says here: ^ Ljjla y iBut sufficient is your Lord as a Guide and Helper.} meaning, for the one who follows His Messenger jfe and believes in His Book, Allah will be his Guide and Helper in this world and the Hereafter. Allah says \$a Guide and Helper.} because the idolators used to try to prevent people from following the Qur'an lest anyone be guided by it. They wanted their way to prevail over the way of the Qur'an. Allah says: iThus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.} jljJji .Jj oil idS'Ai==> \1~J si*. gc J_>i Vp Jijj} \$ ^ 'A&

169 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (32 - 34) (Part-19) <\$32. And those who disbelieve say: "Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once?" Thus, that We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages. <\$33. And no example or parable do they bring, but We reveal to you the truth, and the better explanation thereof.} <\$34. Those who will be gathered to Hell on their faces, such will be in an evil state, and most astray from the path.} The Reason why the Qur'an was revealed in Stages, the Refutation of the Disbelievers, and their Evil End Allah tells us about the many objections raised by the disbelievers, their stubbornness, and how they spoke of things which were none of their concern. They said: i"Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once?"} meaning, why was this Qur'an, which was revealed to him, not sent down all at one time, as the previous Books, the Tawrah, Injil, Zabur and other Divine Books? Allah answered them, telling them that it was revealed in stages over twenty-three years, according to events and circumstances, and whatever rulings were needed, in order to strengthen the hearts of the believers, as He says: 4And (it is) a Qur'an which We have divided (into parts)...} (17:106). Allah says: iiiia3\$ sSi} i that We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages.} Qatadah said it means: "We have explained it." 'Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said it means: "We have given its interpretation." |i| At-Tabari 19:266.

171 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (35 - 40) (Part-19) make him walk on his face on the Day of Resurrection .n* 1 ' tail L'.Ui . lLU-j v^=j' isyQ l* T£j} . > •»:•< < >!,; ; ' : > '•:* / *; . pi?" .tr L*-= U gy j*j»j '! \$,J«\$J» (HV-** !*) { \$;0 cz% zps ;|:q> cstf; p&z fev? a ££fe <^s % 4 , i'], -CZlftV. y |j&=a j; \yjf--=*i jrtj' fj' j" 435. And indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, and placed his brother Hariin with him as a helper;} 436. And We said: "Go you both to the people who have denied Our Aydt." Then We destroyed them with utter destruction .} 437. And Niih's people, when they denied the Messengers, We drowned them, and We made them as a sign for mankind. And We have prepared a painful torment for the

wrongdoers.} 438. And (also) "Ad and Thamiid, and the Dwellers of Ar- Rass, and many generations in between.} 439. And for each We put forward examples, and each We brought to utter ruin.} 440. And indeed they have passed by the town on which was rained the evil rain. Did they not then see it? Nay! But they used not to expect any resurrection .} Frightening the Idolaters ofQuraysh Allah threatens the idolators who denied and opposed His Messenger Muhammad ^ and He warns them of the punishment and painful torment He sent upon the previous nations who rejected their Messengers. Allah begins by mentioning Musa, upon him be peace, whom He sent along with his brother HarQn as a helper - i.e., as another Prophet who helped and supported him - but Fir'awn and his chiefs denied them both: iAlldh destroyed them completely, and similar (awaits) the 111 Ahmad 3:229.

disbelievers> (47:10). And when the people ofNuh denied him, Allah destroyed them likewise, for whoever denies one Messenger denies all the Messengers, because there is no difference between one Messenger and another. If it had so happened that Allah had sent all His Messengers to them, they would have denied them all. Allah says: iAnd Nuh's people, when they denied the Messengers although Allah sent only NOh to them, and he stayed among them for 950 years, calling them to Allah and warning them of His punishment, m^ sa; 'Uj> iAnd none believed with him, except afew (11:40). For this reason Allah drowned them all and left no one among the sons ofAdam alive on earth apart from those who boarded the boat. iand We made them a sign for mankind.> meaning a lesson to be learned. This is like the Ayah, iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the boat. That We might make it a remembrance for you, and the keen ear may understand it> (69:1 1-12), which means: We left for you ships that you ride upon to travel across the depths of the seas, so that you may remember the blessing of Allah towards you when He saved you from drowning, and made you the descendants of those who believed in Allah and followed His commandments.' iAnd (also) 'Ad and Thamud, and the Dwellers ofAr-Rass We have already discussed their story, which is referred to in more than one Surah, such as Surat Al-A'raf [I] and there is m See volume four, the Tafsirof Surat Al-A'raf.

173Surah 25. Al-Furqan (35 - 40) (Part-19) no need to repeat it here. As for the Dwellers of Ar-Rass, Ibn Jurayj narrated from Ibn 'Abbas about the Dwellers of Ar-Rass that they were the people of one of the villages of Thamud.' Ath-Thawri narrated from Abu Bukayr from Ikrimah that Ar- Rass was a well where they buried (Rassu) their Prophet.¹² iand many generations in between.} means nations, many more than have been mentioned here, whom We destroyed. Allah said: iAndfor each We putforward examples,} meaning, *We showed them the proof and gave them clear evidence,' as Qatadah said, "They had no excuse."³ ' iand each (ofthem) We brought to utter ruin.} means, *We destroyed them completely.' This is like the Ayah, iAnd how many generations (Quriin) have We destroyed after Null!} (17:17). "Generations" (Qurun) here refers to nations among mankind. This is like the Ayah, iThen, after them, We created other generations (Quriin).} (23:42) Some defined a generation as being 120 years, or it was said that a generation was one hundred years, or eighty, or forty, etc. The most correct view is that a generation refers to nations who are one another's contemporaries, living at the same time. When they go and others succeed them, this is another generation, as it was recorded in the Two Sahihs: '* At-Tabari 19:269. 21 Al-Baghawi 3 :369 , Al-Qurtubi 13 :32 At-Tabari 19:272.

«77ie best of generations is my generation, then the one that follows it, then the one that follows thatJ ll] 'jSk* OpJ jf ijii indeed they have passed by the town on which was rained the evil rain.} refers to the town of the people of Lut, which was called Sodom, and the way in which Allah dealt with it, when He destroyed it by turning it upside down and by sending upon it the rain of stones of baked clay, as Allah says: ;n ££\$ 4And We rained on them a rain . And how evil was the rain of those who had been warned!} (26:176), \$3 ;'g: A# 4Verily, you pass by than in the morning. And at night; will you not then reflect?} (37:137-138), 4\$d* 00 iAnd verily, they were right on the highroad.} (15:76), ><4<40 iThey are both on an open highway, plain to see (15:79). Allah says: 4Did they not then see it?} meaning, so that they might learn a lesson from what happened to its inhabitants of punishment for denying the Messenger ig and going against the commands of Allah. iNay! But they used not to expect any resurrection.} means, the disbelievers who passed by it did not learn any lesson, because they did not expect any resurrection, i.e., on Fath Al-Bari 5 :306 , Muslim 4 :1963

275Surah 25. Al-Furqan (41 - 44) (Part-19)

the Day of Judgement. 0^ A>b iSf^ 4' l£i 0* bLiJ jI£= it} lIj3XA> 14& eSJi 4' vi £4j.c -><" ><*/-' v-L^W c# §5*^ i3 £ •• •" >' <, T""Sf -• OJUl >0y» MVl i> r' *4* oj^ •f >'• •"I • ! <1 > "-5 _^1 O' V *ff »» * C » #y» j) pluVIf V) |»A iAi" And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger?"} 442. "He would have nearly misled us from our gods, had it not been that we were patient and constant in their worship!" And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astray from the path!} 443 . Have you seen him who has taken as his god his own vain desire? Would you then be a guardian over him?} 444. Or do you think that most of them hear or understand? They are only like cattle - nay, they are even farther astray from the path.}

How the Disbelieversmocked the Messengeri

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4043–4067]

Allah tells us how the disbelievers mocked the Messenger \$\$, when they saw him. This is like the Ayah, ^ &mm Hi tmmm ^ <ss * ^ss, ./ s *•?,-' ? . >' >ybCpIhj;4-^» r.-i -r^^^ ^ r Jftykj^

Tii>* -tJ'iy <And w/ien the disbelievers see you, they take you not except for mockery}' (21:36), which means that they tried to find faults and shortcomings in him. Here Allah says: 4'i 'sM '55>1 *2-* o) Mj ^And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger?"} i.e., they said this by way of belittling and tying to undermine him, so Allah put them in their place, and said: 445*& iAnd indeed Messengers before you were mocked at} (6:10) i'L&f £ bUj tt. iHe would have nearly misled usfrom our gods,} They meant: Tie nearly turned us away from worshipping idols, and he would have done so, had we not been patient and persevered in our ways.' So Allah said, warning and threatening them: <tu iAnd they will know, when they see the torment...} They took Their Desires as their gods and were more astray than Cattle Then Allah tells His Prophet jg that if Allah decrees that someone will be misguided and wretched, then no one can guide him except Allah, gloiy be to Him: Xj\ £ ilyfy iHave you seen him who has taken as his god his own vain desire?}

meaning, whatever he admires and sees as good in his own desires becomes his religion and his way. As Allah says:

41s he then, to whom the evil of his deeds is made fair seeming. So that he consider it as good. Verily, Allah sends astray whom he wills.} [35:8] 4U=j& ^} iWould you then be a guardian over him?} Ibn ‘Abbas said: “During the Jahiliyyah, a man would worship a white rock for a while, then if he saw another that looked better, he would worship that and leave the first.” Then Allah said: ikfe i pUJ 34^ ft iOr do you think that most of them hear or understand?} meaning, they sire worse than grazing cattle. Cattle only do what they were created to do, but these people were created to worship Allah Alone without associating partners with Him, but they worship others with Him, even though evidence has been established against them and Messengers have been sent to them. & oZbi uZ 2 gc£2 jg jiii £ 3 \$} FPS '&p& 4^% 5U5 2 445. Have you not seen how your Lord spread the shadow. If He willed, He could have made it still - but We have made the sun its guide.} 446. Then We withdraw it towards Ourselves - a gradual withdrawal.} 447. And it is He Who makes tlte night a covering for you, and the sleep (as) a repose, and makes the day Nushiir.} Evidence ofthe existence ofthe Creator and the extent ofHis Power Here Allah begins explaining the evidence for His existence l 1 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :260

and His perfect power to create various things and pairs of opposites. All&h says: iHave you not seen how your Lord spread the shadow. Ibn ‘Abbas, Ibn Umar, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Abu Malik, Masruq, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, An-Nakhal, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said, “This refers to the period from the beginning of the dawn until the sun rises.” i&C iw to ilfHe willed, He could have made it still meaning, immobile, never changing. This is like the Ayat. iSay : “Tell me! If Allah made the night continuous for you...’>(28:71) ui& uu. 'to ibut We have made the sun its guide.} means, were it not for the sun rising, it would not be there, for a thing can only be known in contrast to its opposite. Qatadah and As-Suddi said, “The sun is a guide which follows the shade until the shade disappears.”*2 ' Ci tjji^ to iThen We withdraw it towards Ourselves - a gradual withdrawal.} This refers to the shade. <te.} igradual} meaning slowly. As-Suddi said: “A gentle, concealed, withdrawal until there is no shade left on earth except under a roofor a tree, and the sun is shining on whatever is above it.” 4a gradual withdrawal.} Ayyub bin MQsa said: “Little by At-Tabari 19 :275, Al-Qurtubi 13:37. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :262

279Surah 25. Al-Furqan (47 - 50) (Part-19) little. icq p S 4And it is He Who makes the night a covering for you,} It covers and conceals all things. This is like the Ayah: 4By the night as it envelops)> (92:1). 4and the sleep a repose, means, a halt to movement so that bodies may rest. For the faculties and limbs get tired from their constant movement during the day when one goes out to earn a living. When night comes, and it becomes quiet, they stop moving, and rest; so sleep provides a rejuvenation for both the body and the soul. 4and makes the day Nushur meaning, people get up and go out to earn a living and attend to their business. This is like the Ayah: <4% i* a s&b 4lt is out ofHis mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek ofHis bounty...} (28:73) CfcQ In <4^ Juj of j*f} jjti \jp4 (4%. jiil) Lili- iLj J £j; ajjj 448. And it is He Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy; and We send down pure Water from the sky,} 449. That We may give life thereby to a dead land, and We give to drink thereofmany of the cattle and men that We have created.} I" Ad-DurrAl-Manthiir 6 :262

150. And indeed We have distributed it among them in order that they may remember the grace of Allah, but most men refuse (out of) gratitude. This is also part of His complete power and supreme authority: Allah sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, i.e., they bring the clouds behind them. The winds are of many different types, depending on the purpose for which they are sent. Some of them form the clouds, others carry the clouds or drive them, and others come ahead of the clouds as heralds announcing their coming. Some of them come before that to stir up the earth, and some of them fertilize or "seed" the clouds to make it rain. Allah says: *And We send down pure water from the sky*, meaning, as a means of purifying it. Abu Sa'd said, "It was said: "O Messenger of Allah, can we perform Wudu' with the water of the well of Buda'ah? For it is a well in which rubbish and the flesh of dogs are thrown. He said: 'Water is pure and nothing makes it impure.'» This was recorded by Ash-Shafil and Ahmad, who graded it Sahih, and also by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Hasan, and by An-Nasal. His saying: *That We may give life thereby to a dead land*, means, a land that waited a long time for rain. It is devoid of vegetation or anything at all. When the rain comes to it, it becomes alive and its hills are covered with all kinds of colorful flowers, as Allah says: *But when We send down water to it, it is stirred to life and (1 ' Musnad Ash-Shafi'i 1 :21 , Ahmad 3 : 31 ; Abu Dawud 1 :53, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1 :203, An-Nasal 1 :174*

181 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (48 - 50) (Part-19) growth...} (41:39). His saying: *And We give to drink thereof many of the cattle and men that We had created.* means, so that animals such as cattle can drink from it, and people who are in desperate need of water can drink from it and water their crops and fruits. This is like the Ayah: *And He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired,* (42:28) *Look then at the effects of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death.* (30:50) His saying: *And indeed We have distributed it among them in order that they may remember* means, We cause rain to fall on this land and not on that, and We cause the clouds to pass over one land and go to another, where We cause sufficient rain to fall so that its people have plenty, but not one drop falls on the first land.' There is a reason and great wisdom behind this. Ibn 'Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with them said: "One year does not have more rain than another, but Allah distributes the rain as He wills. Then he recited this Ayah: *And indeed We have distributed it (rain or water) amongst them in order that they may remember the grace of Allah, but most men refuse (out of) ingratitude.*"¹ meaning, so that they may be reminded, when Allah brings

111 At-Tabari 19:280.

183 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (51 - 54) (Part-19) 453. And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter; and He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} 454. And it is He Who has created man from water, and has appointed for him kindred by blood, and kindred by marriage. And your Lord is Ever All-Powerful to do what He wills.} The universality of the Prophet's Message, how He was supported in His Mission and Allah's Blessings to Mankind Allah says: *And had We willed, We would have raised a wamer in every town.* 'Calling them to Allah, but We have singled you out, O Muhammad, to be sent to all the people of earth, and We have commanded you to convey the Qur'an,' *that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach* (6 :19). *but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place* (11 :17). *that you may warn the Mother of the Towns and all around it* (42 :7). 4 Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah.. ." (7 :

158). In the Two Sahihs (it is reported that the Prophet said:) ل «I have been sent to the red and the black . » And:

184 Tafsir Ibn Kathir • • -A Prophet would be sent to his own people, but I have been sent to all of mankind.»(11 Allah says: 4* a Ug&K %) <So obey not the disbelievers, but strive hard against them with it> meaning, with the Qur'an. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas.*2! 4fi^=> ^ iwith the utmost endeavour.) This is like the Ayah, 'fe=*JJ 40 Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites,) (9:73) 4.And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter;) means. He has created the two kinds of water, sweet and salty. The sweet water is like that in rivers, springs and wells, which is fresh, sweet, palatable water. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj and of Ibn Jarir, and this is the meaning without a doubt, for nowhere in creation is there a sea which is fresh and sweet. Allah has told us about reality so that His servants may realize His blessings to them and give thanks to Him. The sweet water is that which flows amidst people. Allah has portioned it out among His creatures according to their needs; rivers and springs in every land, according to what they need for themselves and their lands. ip£ m Muslim 1 :370, FathAl-Bari 1 :634. At-Tabari 19:281.

185 Surah 25, Al-Furqan (51 - 54) (Part-19) 4and that is salty and bitter;} meaning that it is salty, bitter and not easy to swallow. This is like the seas that are known in the east and the west, the Atlantic Ocean and the Straits that lead to it, the Red Sea, the Arabian Sea, the Persian Gulf, the China Sea, the Indian Ocean, the Mediterranean Sea, the Black Sea and so on, all the seas that are stable and do not flow, but they swell and surge in the winter and when the winds are strong, and they have tides that ebb and flow. At the beginning of each month the tides ebb and flood, and when the month starts to wane they retreat until they go back to where they started. When the crescent of the following month appears, the tide begins to ebb again until the fourteenth of the month, then it decreases. Allah, may He be glorified, the One Whose power is absolute, has set these laws in motion, so all of these seas are stationary, and He has made their water salty lest the air turn putrid because of them and the whole earth turn rotten as a result, and lest the earth spoil because of the animals dying on it. Because its water is salty, its air is healthy and its dead are good (to eat), hence when the Messenger of Allah j|| was asked whether sea water can be used for Wudu', he said: «ts water is pure and its dead are lawful .» This was recorded by Malik, Ash-Shafil and Ahmad, and by the scholars of Sunan with a good [Jayyid] chain of narration. iand He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} meaning, between the sweet water and the saltwater. 4a barrier} means a partition, which is dry land. *** Al-Muwattd' 1:22, Musnad Ash-Shafi'i 1:23, Ahmad 2:361, Abu Dawud 1 :64, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 1 :224, An-Nasat 1 :50, Ibn Majah

187 Siirah 25. Al-Furqan (55 - 60) (Part-19) ibJ,o iand has appointed for him kindred by blood, and kindred by marriage.} in the beginning, he is someone's child, then he gets married and becomes a son-in-law, then he himself has sons-in-law and other relatives through marriage. All of this comes from a despised liquid, Allah says: 4& &} 4And your Lord is Ever All-Powerful to do what He wills.} 'ip & 'io V t* j* jjamj} ^4 A-Zig pf===tLi-*i L js mj! , >S. ***">>' *? * •"'if <' Vs. 't' *ti </=*> -JsL^4 ctri ^ S' aL- ^ Li Uj jjJb o^ . jnP J^S *>/>*/ 455. And they worship besides Allah, that which can neither profit them nor harm them ; and the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.} 456. And Vie have sent you only as a bearer of good news and a wamer.} 457. Say: "No reward do I ask of you for this, save that whosoever wills may take a path to his Lord."} 458. And put your trust in the Ever Living One Wfw

dies not, and glorify His praises, and sufficient is He as the All-Knower of the sins of His servants,} 459. Wlw created the heavens and the earth and all that is between them in six Days. Then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne. The Most Gracious! Ask Him, as He is the All- Knower.} 460. And when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahmdn!" They say: "And what is Ar-Rahman? Shall we fall down in prostration to that which you command us?" And it increases in them only aversion.}

The Ignorance of the Idolaters Allah tells us how ignorant the idolaters are; instead of worshipping Allah, they worship idols which do not possess the power either to harm or benefit. They do this with no evidence or proof; the only thing that led them to do this was their own whims and desires. So they take these idols as protectors and fight for their sake, and they oppose Allah and His Messenger jg and the believers for their sake. Similarly Allah says: iand the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.} meaning, he is a supporter of Shaytan against the party of Allah, but the party of Allah are the ones who will prevail, as Allah says: (* (*-*J (V** V SI? vfhi m).** *Ul* OjJ \)ij£-)} iAnd they have taken besides Allah gods , hoping that they might be helped. They cannot help them, but they will be brought forward as a troop against those who worshipped them.} (36:74-75) meaning, the gods which they worshipped instead of Allah cannot help them. These ignorant people are troops for the idols and are ready to fight for their sake and protect their sanctuaries, but in the end the victory will be for Allah and His Messenger sg and the believers, in this world and the Hereafter. iand the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.} Mujahid said: "He supports and helps the Shayt&n in disobedience towards Allah. The Messenger^ brings Glad Tidings and Warnings Then Allah tells His Messenger jg: Vj&j 1^** VI vibQ Lj} iAnd We have sent you only as a bearer of good news and a

189 Surah 25. Al-Furqdn (55 - 60) (Part-19) wamer. meaning, a bringer of good news to the believers, a wamer to the disbelievers; bringing good news of Paradise to those who obey Allah, and bringing warnings of a dreadful punishment for those who go against the commandments of Allah. St fS t 4 Say : "No reward do I ask of you for this..." "for conveying this message and this warning, I do not ask for any reward from your wealth; I am only doing this for the sake of Allah, may He be exalted.' iTto whomsoever among you who wills to walk straight) (81:28). isave that whosoever wills, may take a path to his Lord.) means, a way and a methodology to be followed. The Command to the Messenger0 to put his Trust in Allah, and some of His Qualities Then Allah says: 4And put your trust in the Ever Living One Who dies not,) meaning, in all your affairs, put your trust in Allah, the Ever- Living Who never dies, the One Who 4^&&%m \$*) 4is the First and the Last, the Most High and tlxe Most Near. And He is tire All-Knower of everything) (57:3). The Eternal, Ever-Lasting, Ever-Living, Self-Sufficient One, the Lord and Sovereign of all things, the One to Whom you should always turn. Allah is the One in Whom you should put your trust and to Whom you should turn for refuge, He will be sufficient for you and will be your helper and supporter, and will cause you to prevail. As Allah says:

191 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (55 - 60) (Part-19) means. He is the Ever-Living Who never dies, He is the Creator, Sustainer and Sovereign of all things, Who by His might and power created the seven heavens with their vast height and width, and the seven earths with their great depths and density. f& 4in six Days. Then He rose over the Throne.} means, He is running all affairs and He decrees according to the truth, and He is the best of those who decide. 4\$ 4Then He rose over (Istawd) the Throne. The Most Gracious! Ask Him, as He is the All-Knoiver> meaning, find out about Him from one who knows most

about Him, and follow him and take him as your example. It is known that there is no one who knows more about Allah than His servant and Messenger Muhammad si, the absolute leader of the sons of Adam in this world and the Hereafter, who does not speak of his own desire, but conveys revelation revealed to him. What he says is true, and he is the leader whose decision counts; when there is a dispute, people are obliged to refer to him, and whatever is in accordance with his words and deeds is right, and whatever goes against them should be rejected no matter who says or does it. Allah says: 4(And) if you differ in anything among yourselves...} (4:59). 4And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah} (42:10). 4^j fo-% siz;} }And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). meaning, He has spoken the truth and is fair and just in His commands and prohibitions. Allah says here:

192 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAsk Him, as He is Al-Knower.} Condemnation of the Idolators Then Allah rebukes the idolators who prostrate to idols and rivals instead of Allah: iji'j i Jj 4And when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahman!" They say: "And what is Ar-Rahman?"} meaning: we do not know Ar-Rahman. They did not like to call Allah by His Name Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), as they objected on the day of (the treaty of) Al-Hudaybiyyah, when the Prophet jg told the scribe: a^^JlO^ 1 ji' 4^1' "Write: "In the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), Ar-Ralum (the Most Merciful)." They said, "We do not know Ar-Rahman or Ar-Rahlm. Write what you used to write: 'Bismika Allahumma (in Your Name, O Allah).' " * 11 So Allah revealed the words: i&n CCIVi \$ u i\ \$if\ \p } if \pi ft iSay: "Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman, by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names} (17:110). meaning, He is Allah and He is the Most Gracious. And in this Ayah, Allah said: iAnd when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahman!" They say: "And wltat is the Ar-Rahman?"} meaning: we do not know or approve of this Name. fe U £3} iShall we fall down in prostration to that which you command us?} means, "Just because you tell us to?" Ahmad 3:268, similar with Muslim no. 1784.

193 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (61 - 62) (Part-19) "And it increases in them only aversion . As for the believers, they worship Allah Who is the Most Gracious, Most Merciful, and they attribute divinity to Him Alone and prostrate to Him. The scholars, agree that it is allowed and approved for the reader and the listener to prostrate when he reaches this mention of prostration in Surat Al-Furqan, and Allah knows best. ££4% 4 4 y >=j, J jljl JUl- JJ' 461 . Blessed be He Who has placed in the heaven Al-Buruj, and has placed therein a great lamp, and a moon giving light.} }62. And He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession (Khilfatan), for such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} Mentioning the Might and Power of Allah Here Allah glorifies Himself and praises the beauty He created in the heavens of Al-Buruj, the giant stars, according to the view of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Al-Hasan and QatadahJ ' This is like the Ayah, 4^~m CTjif xAj} 4And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps} (67:5). Allah says: 4Blessed be He Who has placed in the heaven Al-Buruj, and has placed therein a great lamp,} which is the sun which shines like a lamp, as Allah says: 4And We have made (therein) a shining lamp} (78:13). At-Tabari 19:289, Al-Baghawi 3 : 374.

and a moon giving light.} means, shining and illuminated by the light of something else, different from the light of the sun, as Allah says: lllli ifjl f} ilt is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon

as a light (10:5). And Allah tells us that Nuh, peace be upon him, said to his people: ' by yj^ & j£. i£j iSee you not how Allah has created the seven heavens one above another? And has made the moon a light therein, and made the sun a lamp?} (71:15-16). Then Allah says: ///» / /< ' <• / // i* /> \ 4^4- 4And He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession (Khil/atan),} meaning, each one comes after the other, in a never-ending alternation. When one goes the other comes, and vice versa, as Allah says: 'Jj% julJtp^j} 4And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses} (14:33). J3C 'j&& 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly} (7:54). ilt is notfor the sun to overtake the moon} (36:40).

ifor such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} means, He has caused them both to follow one another to show the times when His servants should worship Him. So whoever misses an act of worship during the night can make it up during the day, and whoever misses an act of worship (faring the day can make it up during the night. It was recorded in a Sahih Hadith: k~L> 1 'Sy—L JIIJj oJj <jl» «JP^ 'Allah spreads forth His Hand at night for the one who has done evil during the day to repent, and He spreads forth His Hand during the day for the one who has done evil during the Jtight to repentV Mujahid and Qatadah said: "Khilfatan means different, i.e., because one is dark and the other is light."121 fa & 4rit c; 'oj&&& tx* Ufx gs jtJ % (Li, Jjtl \+> \ i)a 4ff <^aj IaZ-Sj ^63 . And the servants of the Most Gracious are those who walk on the earth Hawna, and when the foolish address them they say; "Saldma."} 464. And those who spend the night in worship of their Lord, prostrate and standing.} 465. And those who say : "Our Lord! Avert from us the torment of Hell. Verily, its torment is ever an inseparable, permanent punishment."} 466. Evil indeed it is as an abode and as a place to rest in.} 467. And those who, when they spend, are neither extravagant nor stingy, but are in a just balance between them.} I1 * Muslim 4 :21 13. At-Tabari 19:290, 291.

Attributes ofthe Servants ofthe Most Gracious These are the attributes of the believing servants of Allah, if ithose who walk on the earth Hawna,} meaning that they walk with dignity and humility, not with arrogance and pride. This is like the Ayah iAnd walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance... (17:37). So these people do not walk with conceit or arrogance or pride. This does not mean that they should walk like sick people, making a show of their humility, for the leader of the sons of Adam (the Prophet) jg used to walk as if he v^ts coming downhill, and as if the earth were folded up beneath him. What is meant here by Hawn is serenity and dignity, as the Messenger ofAllah jgj said: Ui £LSwJl lay\j K pit I J lap yyii ^li laj 1 jLSai l^la uWhen you come to the prayer, do not come rushing in haste. Come calmly and with tranquility, and whatever you catch up with, pray, and whatever you miss, make it upM iand when thefoolish address them they say: "Saldma."} If the ignorant people insult them with bad words, they do not respond in kind, but they forgive and overlook, and say nothing but good words. This is what the Messenger of Allah jgg did: the more ignorant the people, the more patient he would be. This is as Allah says: iAnd when they hear Al-Laghwa (evil or vain talk), they withdrawfrom it} (28:55). 111 FathAl-BQri2 :453 .

197Surah 25. Al-Furqan (63 - 67) (Part-19) Then Allah says that their nights are the best of nights, as He says: iAnd those who spend the night in worship of their Lord, prostrate and standing.} meaning, worshipping and obeying Him. This is like the Ayat iThey used to sleep but little by night. And in the hours before dawn, they were askingforforgiveness (51:17-18). •>> >y 0* i!S iTheir sidesforsake their

beds...} (32:16). i-ifj [fr/j {£\$1 ji lf\} ils one who is obedient to Allah, prostrating himself or standing during the hours of the night, fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy of his Lord...} (39:9). Allah says: iAnd those who say: "Our Lord! Avert from us the torment of Hell. Verily, its torment is ever an inseparable punishment."} meaning, ever-present and never ending. Al-Hasan said concerning the Ayah, <<j\} iVerily, its torment is ever an inseparable, permanent punishment.} Everything that strikes the son of Adam, then disappears, does not constitute an inseparable, permanent punishment. The inseparable, permanent punishment is that which lasts as long as heaven and earth. 111 This was also the view of Sulayman At-Taymi. 121 Qf} AMabari 19:297. 121 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :72

199 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (68 - 71) (Part-19) 468. And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause, nor commit illegal sexual intercourse - and whoever does this shall receive Athdama.} 469. The torment will be doubled for him on the Day of Resurrection, and he will abide therein in disgrace 470. Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds; for those, Allah will change their sins into good deeds, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.> 471. And whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds; then indeed he has repented to Allah Mataba

The Attributes of the Servants of the Most Gracious

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4067–4076]

include avoiding Shirk, Murder and Zina Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "The Messenger of Allah was asked which sin is the most serious?" He said: «That you appoint a rival to Allah when He has created you.n He asked, "Then what?" He said: aThat you kill your child for fear that he may eat with you .» He said, "Then what?" He said: aThat you commit adultery with your neighbor's wife.n 'Abdullah said, "Then Allah revealed, confirming that: 4And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah....y* 1 This was also recorded by An-Nasal, 121 and by Al-Bukhari 111 Ahmad 1 : 380. 121 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :420

200 Tafstr Ibn Kathir and Muslim. It was narrated that Said bin Jubayr heard Ibn 'Abbas saying that some of the people of Shirk killed a great deal and committed Zina a great deal, then they came to Muhammad and said: "What you are saying and calling people to is good, if only you would tell us that there is a way to expiate for what we have done." Then the Ayah: iAnd those who invoke not any other god along with Allah.. .} was revealed, as was the Ayah, "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves!"} (39:53). jl dfri jl£ fff} iand whoever does this shall receive Athama.} It was recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said: "Athama is a valley in Hell."131 'Ikrimah also said that Athama refers to valleys in Hell in which those who commit unlawful sexual acts will be punished. This was also narrated from Said bin Jubayr and MujahidJ4 As-SuddI said that Athama referred to punishment, which is closer to the apparent meaning of the Ayah. This interpretation makes it interchangeable with what comes next, the Ayah: 4-04' ri 5 J&Sfr 4The torment will be doubled far him on the Day of Resurrection,} i.e., repetitive and intensified. iand lw will abide therein in disgrace;} scorned and humiliated. FathAl-Bari 12:116, Muslim 1 :90 91 At-Tabari 9 :414. At-Tabari 19:308. (4) At-Tabari 19:308.

202 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (68 - 72) (Part-19) 4 Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds;) means, those who do these evil deeds will be punished in the manner described, 406 & 4 Except those who repent), that is; those who repent in this world to Allah from all of those deeds, for then Allah will accept their repentance. This is evidence that the repentance of the murderer is acceptable, and there is no contradiction between this and the Ayah in Surat An-Nisa 4 And whoever kills a believer intentionally) (4:93), because even though this was revealed in Al-Madina, the meaning is general, and it could be interpreted to refer to one who does not repent, because this Ayah states that forgiveness is only for those who repent. Moreover Allah says: <ilj£ OJJ £ 4r4 J ^ «£' i Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but He forgives except that to whom He wills) (4:48). And in the authentic Sunnah, it is reported from the Messenger of Allah Hg that the repentance of a murderer is acceptable, as was stated in the story of the person who killed one hundred men and then repented, and Allah accepted his repentance, and other Hadiths . [1 3 ^ Zu&) 4 for those, Allah will change their sins into good deeds, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: ijl iUJ' /Aj ji j >£• u'! : JIL* : Jli i ft- o —_* j\1S Iy-u \ tjftls fSt' ' 0 V • JjXi i \ 4 \SS oJ 4 1jSj l.o 4 oJup Al-Bukhari no. 3470, and Muslim no. 7008.

*r ^ J& JiJ j)i ilili kljj^ j{ U13! V suil </ know the last person who will be brought forth from Hell, and the last person who will enter Paradise. A man will be brought and it will be said, "Take away his major sins and ask him about his minor sins." So it will be said to him: "On such and such a day, you did such and such, and on such and such a day, you did such and such." He will say, "Yes, and he will not be able to deny anything." Then it will be said to him: "For every evil deed you now have one good merit." He will say: "O Lord, I did things that I do not see here." He (Abu Dharr) said: "And the Messenger of Allah jg smiled so broadly that his molars could be seen." Muslim recorded it.121 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Jabir heard MakhQl say, "A very old man with sunken eyes came and said, 'O Messenger of Allah, a man betrayed others and did immoral deeds, and there was no evil deed which he did not do. If (his sins) were to be distributed among the whole of mankind, they would all be doomed. Is there any repentance for him?'"The Messenger of Allah jg said: *Have you become Muslim ?» He said, "As for me, I bear witness that there is no God but Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger." The Prophet M said: oL> Sic JjIsj U JIJ jli *Allah will forgive you for whatever you have done like that, and will replace your evil deeds with good merits .» The man said: "O Messenger of Allah, even my betrayals and immoral actions?"The Prophet said: m Ahmad 5:170. 121 Muslim 1 :177.

tEven your betrayals and immoral actions .» "The man went away saying 'La ilaha iUallah' and 'AUahu Akbar" Allah tells us how His mercy extends to all His creatures, and that whoever among them repents to Him, He will accept his repentance for any sin, great or small. Allah says: 4And whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds; then indeed he has repented to Allah Mataba.} meaning, Allah will accept his repentance. This is like the Ayat YSZi ,»/ ^ Jit . •' 4ji\ v»J /C-JU jtJaJ jl '*>— 0*Jr iAnd whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful^ (4:110). z y>S 3 iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants?...} (9:104). 4Say: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah."} (39:53) - for those who repent to Him. 'i) dz&j iv' iv'

'ijj -£\$' V Cj C-i cL>\$yi oji'j .i«£> 472. And those who do not bear witness to falsehood, and if they pass by some evil play or evil talk, they pass by it with Ibn Abi Hatim and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :281 . This narration is not authentic. There is a similar, but shorter narration from Anas, recorded by Abu Yala, Al-Bazzar, and At-Tabarani.

204 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr dignity.^ 173. And those who, when they are reminded of the Ayat of their Lord, fall not deafand blind thereat.> 174. And those who say: “Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes, and make us leaders of those who have Taqwa More Attributes ofthe Servants ofthe Most Gracious These are further attributes of the servants of the Most Gracious. They do not bear witness to falsehood, including lies, immorality, disbelief, foul speech and false words. ‘Amr bin Qays said, this refers to gatherings of sexual immorality. It was said that the Ayah, A& v> AAnd those who do not bear witness tofalsehood refers to giving false testimony, which means lying deliberately to someone else. It was recorded in the Two SahXhs that Abu Bakrah said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said three times: “Shall I not tell you of the greatest ofmajor sins?» We said, “Of course, O Messenger of Allah.” The Messenger ofAllah said: «Associating others in worship with Allah and disobeying one's parents . He was lying down, then he sat up and added: < t}jij Vi® “Bewarefalse speech, and bearing witness tofalsehoodj and he kept repeating it until we thought, would that he would stop.” From the context it seems that what is meant by those who do not bear witness to falsehood is those who do not attend it or Fath Al-Bari 5 :309 , Muslim 1 :91 .

are not present when it happens. Allah says: !vP !v<& iand if they pass by some evil play or evil talk, they pass by it with dignity.)> They do not attend where falsehood occurs, and if it so happens that they pass by it, they do not let it contaminate them in the slightest. Allah says: ip) itthey pass by it with dignity.) 'ij. <Pf(i) \$And those who, when they are reminded of the Ayat of their Lord, fall not deafand blind thereat.) This is also a characteristic of the believers, fa £a: sg fijs ££ & X lit p) iThose who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Ayat are recited unto them, they increase theirfaith; and they put their trust in their Lord.) (8:2) Unlike the disbelievers. When they hear the Words of Allah, they are not affected by them or moved to change their ways. They persist in their disbelief, wrongdoing, ignorance and misguidance, as Allah says: \pc <<3 ki 28jW 4As &^ t \$L 4 £'S 4And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them say “Which ofyou has had his faith increased by it?” As for those who believe, it has increased theirfaith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add doubt to their doubt) (9:124-125). [£.js \$) 4fall not deaf and blind thereat.) means, unlike the disbelievers

who, when they hear the Ayat ofAllah, are not moved by them, but continue as they are, as if they did not hear them but are deafand blind. His saying: U ->yjH iAnd those who say: "Our Lord! Bestow on usfrom our wives and our ofjspring the comfort ofour eyes . means those who ask Allah to bring forth from their loins offspring who will obey Him and worship Him and not associate anything in worship with Him. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means (offspring) who will strive to obey Allah and bring them joy in this world and the Hereafter.”* 11 Imam Ahmad recorded that Jubayr bin Nufayr said: “We sat with Al-Miqdad bin Al-Aswad one day, and a man passed by and said, “How blessed are these two eyes which saw the Messenger of Allah j\$! Would that we had seen what you saw and witnessed what you witnessed.” Al-Miqdad got angry, and I was surprised, because the man had not said anything but good.

Then he turned to him and said, “What makes a man wish to be present when Allah had caused him to be absent, and he does not know how he would have behaved if he had been there? By Allah, there are people who saw the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and Allah will throw them on their faces in Hell because they did not accept him or believe in him. Are you not grateful that Allah brought you forth from your mothers’ wombs believing in your Lord and in what your Prophet brought, and that the test went to others and not to you? Allah sent His Prophet during the most difficult time that any Prophet was ever sent, after a long period of ignorance, when the people could see no better religion than the worship of idols, and he brought the Criterion which distinguishes truth from falsehood and which would separate a father from his son. A man would realize that his father, son or brother was a disbeliever, and since Allah had opened his heart to Faith, he knew that if his relative died he would go to Hell, so he could not rest knowing that his loved one was in the Fire. This is what Allah referred to in the Ayah, m At-Tabari 19:318.

4And those who say : "Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes . Its chain of narrators is Sahih, although they did not report it.' 1 ' i and make us leaders of those who have Taqwa.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Rabi‘ bin Anas said: “Leaders who would be taken as examples in good.”*21 Others said: “Guides who would call others to goodness.” They wanted their worship to be connected to the worship of their children and offspring, and their guidance to go beyond themselves and benefit others. This would be more rewarding and a better end, as it was recorded in Sahih Muslim from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *& jJj ji ft oi 1^ 'H mm | * mm* m • 43JL^ j I i oJju fjA riNhen a son of Adam dies, his deeds cease apart from three: a righteous child who will pray for him, knowledge from which others may benefit after him, or ongoing charity .»'31 £vplli£j li4 lifj <£\$>) Cj sp,2%£ v #£ £ j* rJtfiSJ ^ 475. Those will be rewarded with the highest place because of their patience. Therein they shall be met with greetings and the word of peace and respect. 476. Abiding therein - excellent it is as an abode, and as a place to rest in.} I 1 * Ahmad 6 :2. At-Tabari 19:319. 3| Muslim 3:1255.

208 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4.77 . Say : “My lord pays attention to you only because of your invocation to Him. But now you have indeed denied. So the torment will be yours forever.> The Reward of the Servants of the Most Gracious, and a

Warning to the People of MafeWah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4076–4077]

After mentioning the beautiful attributes of His believing servants, and their fine words and deeds, Allah then says: 4Those\$> meaning, the people who are described in this manner, 4will be rewarded on the Day of Resurrection, iwith the highest placeK which is Paradise. Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said, “It was so called because of its elevation.” ibecause of their patience. means, their patience in doing what they did. 4Therein they shall be mefy means, in Paradise. iwith greetings and the word of peace and respect. This means that they will be greeted first with words of welcome and honor. Peace will be theirs and they will be wished peace. And angels shall enter unto them from every gate, saying, “Peace be upon you for that you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed

is the final home!" iAbiding therein means, they will settle there and never leave or move or die, they will never exit or wish to move to somewhere else. This is like the Ayah,

209 Surah 25. Al-Furqan (75 - 77) (Part-19) oij C ciyji- i£[f jp IjlfL \$j} 4A«d f/iouse who are blessed, they will be in Paradise, abiding therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure^ (11 : 108). 4excellent it is as an abode, and as a place to rest in.} Its appearance is beautiful and it is a good place in which to rest and to dwell. Then Allah says: iSay: "My Lord pays attention to you only because of your invocation to Him..."} meaning, He would not care to pay attention to you if you did not worship Him, for He only created mankind to worship Him Alone and to glorify Him morning and evening. His saying: iZZ&} iBut now you have indeed denied.} "O you disbelievers." 4*-*y }So the torment will be yours forever.} So your denial will remain with you forever, i.e., it will lead to your punishment, doom and destruction in this world and the Hereafter. This also refers to the day of Badr, as it was interpreted by 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Ubayy bin Ka'b, Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-SuddI and others. ^jy~>} iSo the torment will be yours forever.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: "The Day of Resurrection."*2 * And there is no conflict between the two interpretations.

Surah 26: Ash-Shuara

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 7

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4078]

Opening The Tafslrof Surat Ash-Shu'ara.' (Chapter - 26)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4078–4090]

(In the Tafslr that was narrated from Malik it was said that this Surah is also known as Surat Al-Jami'ah) In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. rw mmw \ ^ —i QljS ff, ul o[(i iyPk ~ v* *1 && » k0^J ^ 801 >.\ t. - i.ilif ^ 'i ^ 'I-W' zf> \$ # ^Oji^—' ^^ <(2. These are Ayat of B°okMM fi , ^ V>- r . v . <3 - U maxJ be that y°u «re going Bakhi' your- (& self> that thexJ do not y^ become believers. 44. //We toil/. We cow/d send dawn to themfrom the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility>

4Perhaps , you would Bdkhi' yourself, over their footsteps, because they believe not in this narration} (18 :6). Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, 'Atiyyah, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan and others said that: 411 may be that you are going Bdkhi' yourself} means, Tail yourself.*111 Then Allah says: \ ^ cikt 4iU ft ilf We will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility.} meaning, 'if We so willed, We could send down a sign that would force them to believe, but We will not do that because We do not want anyone to believe except by choice.' Allah says: WS? isr oitil \LE - oiyVf 4 &j ;tS ff} 4And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. So, will you then compel mankind, until they become believers.} (10 :99) ^ *-^1}^ iff" fj} 4And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely, have made mankind one Ummah...>(11 :118) But Allah's will has acted, His decree has come to pass, and His proof has been conveyed to mankind by mission of Messengers and the revelation of Books to them. Then Allah says: ** Iff if If} if pplji &>} 4And never comes there unto them a Reminder as a recent revelation from the Most Gracious, but they him away therefrom.} m At-Tabari 19:330, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:360.

214 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, every time a Scripture comes from heaven to them, most of the people turn away from it. As Allah says: }And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12 :103) 4 J 'it " ^1 ^ it-Jl iAlas for mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} (36 :30) /> v r> 4Then We sent Our Messengers in succession. Every time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him...} (23 :44). Allah says here: >(t • • 4So, they have indeed denied, then the news of what they mocked at will come to them.} meaning, they denied the truth that came to them, so they will come to know the news of the consequences of this denial after a while. 4^,

JLi ii '4 4And those who do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned} (26 :227). Then Allah tells those who dared to oppose His Messenger and disbelieve in His Book, that He is the Subduer, the Almighty, the All-Powerful, Who created the earth and caused every good kind of crop, fruit and animal to grow therein. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from a man from Ash-ShaTsi that people are a product of the earth. So whoever enters Paradise is good and noble, and whoever enters Hell is base and vile.111 iVerily, in this is an Ayah,} meaning an evidence of the power of * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :289 .

215Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (10 - 22) (Part-19) Sit'*- - • 'i'''/yy ' ' | fcWtSj&iO&P* \$ I<A?A\ “ j pzM&%j_ ^ oA^ Cp?£*£\$£&£, ^the Creator of all things. He spread out the earth and raised the canopy of the hea- vens, yet despite that the majority of people do not believe, rather they deny Him, His Messengers, and His Books, and they go against His commands doing the things He had prohibited. His saying: 4And verily your Lord, He is truly the All- Mighty,} means, the One Who has power over all things, to subdue and control them, 4the Most Merciful.} means, towards His creation, for He does not hasten to punish the one who sins, but He gives him time to repent, •and if he does not, then He seizes him with a mighty punishment. Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas and Ibn Ishaq said: “He is Almighty in His punishment of those who went against His commands and worshipped others besides Him.” ’ Said bin Jubayr said: “He is Most Merciful towards those who repent to Him and turn to Him.” ijU-1 Cp 36 'IjpOyii1 Sft ijti (j* sjlc&jrktf s3 ^ && C!S& <& Hi sji c& jjK% JblZ <1h*& J yji C& GillV 36 J 111 At-Tabari 33 :304, 3 :260 , 5 :51 1

oi \$ JB ~{jt. -y 6; tl> lij Ifiili 3tt cijj oi*» ^ _iH*j ollij ili o? 4^* 4> 4 s**>* (^44- 12 j^« iyjjj 4;'Vj l/l rC IjcI *-5 -K dS 410. And (remember) when your Lord called Musa (saying) "Go to the people who are wrongdoers."} 111. "The people ofFira'wn. Will they not have Taqwd?"} 112. He said: "My Lord! Verily, I fear that they will deny me,"} 113. "And my breast straitens, and my tongue expresses not well. So sendfor Harun."} 114. "And they have a charge of crime against me, and I fear they will kill me."} 115. (Allah) said: "Nay! Go you both with Our signs. Verily, We shall be with you, listening."} 116. "And go both of you to Fira'wn, and say: ‘We are the Messengers of the Lord ofAl-'Alamin,’} 117. 'So allow the Children of Israel to go with us.'"} 118. (Fir'awn) said (to Milsa): “Did we not bring you up among us as a child? And you did dwell many years of your life with us."} 419. "And you did your deed, which you did. While you were one of the ingrates."} 420. Musa said: "I did it then, when I was in error."} 421. "So, Ifledfrom you when Ifeared you. But my Lord has granted me HukmJ and made me one ofthe Messengers."} 422 . "And this is the past favor with which you reproach me, - that you have enslaved the Children ofIsrael."} BetweenMusa and Fir*awn Allah tells us what He commanded His servant, son of Imran and Messenger Musa, peace be upon him, who spoke with m SeeAyah no. 83 as follows later.

Him, to do, when He called him from the right side of the mountain, and conversed with him, and chose him, sent him and commanded him to go to Fir'awn and his people. Allah says: t:J <-&* xj\ #{C Vs •Vs >/ i3riH) iAnd when your Lord called Musa: "Go to the people who are wrongdoers. Tlte people of Fir'awn. Will they not have Taqwa?" He said: "My Lord! Verily, I fear that they will deny me. And my breast straitens, and my tongue expresses not well. So send for Hariin. And they have a charge of crime against me, and Ifear they will kill me."} So, Musa asked Allah to remove these difficulties for him, as

he said in Surah Ta Ha iMusa said: "O my Lord! Open for me my chest. And ease my taskfor me."} (20:25-26) until: 4You are granted your request, O Miisdl} (20:36) &&&&m iAnd they have a charge of crime against me, and I fear they will kill me.} because he had killed that Egyptian, which was the reason that he left the land of Egypt. i(Allah) said: "Nay!..."} Allah told him: do not be afraid of anything like that. This is like the Ayah, Jul &:} iAllah said: "We will strengthen your arm through your brother, and give you both power} meaning, proof;

219Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (22 - 28) (Part-19 manner: you killed one of our men and denied our favors to you.' So he said to him: iWhile you were one of the ingrates.) meaning, one of those who deny favors. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir.*11 i\>[i(Miisa) said: "I did it then..." meaning, at that time, iwhen I was in error.) meaning, before revelation was sent to me and before Allah made me a Prophet and sent me with this Message.' iSo, I fled from you when I feared you. But my Lord has granted me Hukm, and made me one of the Messengers.) means, 'the first situation came to an end and another took its place. Now Allah has sent me to you, and if you obey Him, you will be safe, but ifyou oppose Him, you will be destroyed.' Then Musa said: Js5'I I OX* o* Je tjL} iO iAnd this is the pastfavor with which you reproach me, - that you have enslaved the Children ofIsrael.) meaning, "whatever favors you did in bringing me up are offset by^ the evil you did by enslaving the Children of Israel and using them to do your hard labor. Is there any comparison between your favors to one man among them and the evil you have done to all of them? What you have mentioned about me is nothing compared to what you have done to them.' \ ju t pp & -PS ju vt p jii |g m At-Tabari 19:340.

noH Jo pj(rj dip si 'vsnyj q -imp oiffr :pws (u<rw,jij)} iw V?&D v fn >!f* iff jf f 'i(vfiy aq} aiRI si ifvfiy siqx,, 'pres ippng-sy suoqBJ3ua3 jajBj jo sureuq aqj pire jBjBg aq} jo sxBjoqos aq} Xq pajajdiajut sbm }i Moq si siqx <(<iaui ireq} jaqjo uimv}y,-jy jo pjoq aqj si Suiuirep bjb noX oqM siqj si oq/yv,, 'unq o} pres umb.jij ,/sppoM aq} jo pjoq aq} jo jaSuassaj^ aq} ure j,, :maqj o} pres ?SDW uaq/v\ -umb,ju ireqj pjoj jaqjo ou psq Xaq} }Bq} paAaaq Xaqj puB 'paguoiS aq an Xbui 'joiBajQ aq} Xuap oj pasn Xaqx (t-S :e^) i'uttii pafhqo Imp puv '3\do3d sit/ pdjooJ 31/ sni/x> (SZ/SZ) i'3iu ump J3ipo poS v aamj nod ivip jou aiouy 4*3E? r? ip' :a(doad siq oj Xbs o} pasn aq asnBoaq si siqx i.uumviy, 3tp/o puo-j dip si mi<n puy,, (:pws umv/ij)} 4fn r? :sXbs an sb 'umb.jij jo jBiuap pus uoissajddo 'uoinaqaj 'jaqaqsip aq} jnoqs sn sjpj qBjv i,,ipuv}SJ3pun ptq pip nodJi 'utdq} uddapdq si W{ } \v puv 'is3<n dip puv }svd dip Jo puoqn :pws (vsnyq) 'szi 4"juvuipvui v si noli 0} }Uds uddq svq oqm joSudssdyj jnod 'H\U3A,, PfOS (uoiv,jij) •/£)> ijsudipvJ iudpuv mod Jo puoj dip puv puoq mo^,, :pws (vsny\ f) -9^ <,,i(sfos 3q fvqai) uvdi(}ou tiofi oq,, :punouv dsoip 0} pws (umv,Jij) -£z¥ i,,tkuwvdo qim pdouiauoo dq oj ydds noH Ji 'uidip uddapdq si ivip pv puv 'ipuvd dip puv sudavdif dip Jo puoq din,, :pivs (vsnyj) fzt i,,iumoiy,-ivJo pjoq dip si ivqtn puy,, :pws uow^ij -£z> jp2 fT crfs# ?r rt* && rc^* m %% & %t- unpvv uqi uisfvi OZZ

two?" He said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright."} (20:49-50) Those among the philosophers and others who claimed that this was a question about the nature or substance (of Allah] are mistaken. Fir'awn did not believe in the Creator in the first place, so he was in no position to ask about the nature of the Creator; he denied that the Creator existed at all, as is apparent from the meaning, even though proof and evidence had been established against him. When

Fir'awn asked him about the Lord of Al-'Alamm, Musa said: 4£&' Cj oyHii 4J ti} i(Musa) said: "The Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them..." meaning, the Creator, Sovereign and Controller of all that, their God Who has no partner or associate. He is the One Who has created all things. He knows the higher realms and the heavenly bodies that are in them, both those that are stationary and those that move and shine brightly. He knows the lower realms and what is in them; the oceans, continents, mountains, trees, animals, plants and fruits. He knows what is in between the two realms; the winds, birds, and whatever is in the air. All of them are servants to Him, submitting and humbling themselves before Him. iUbis ft 4^ iifyou seek to be convinced with certainty.} means, if you have believing hearts and clear insight. At this, Fir'awn turned to the chiefs and leaders of his state around him, and said to them - mockingly expressing his disbelief in Musa: 4S, \$} i"Do you not hear?" meaning, 'are you not amazed by what this man is claiming - that you have another god other than me?' Mass said to them: 4Your Lord and the Lord of your ancient fathers!}

meaning, the One Who created you and your forefathers, those who came before Fir'awn and his time. } Hc said} that is, Fir'awn said: 4Verily, your Messenger who has been sent to you is a madman!} meaning, there is no sense in his claim that there is any god other than me!' i(Musa) said} - to those in whose hearts Fir'awn had planted doubts: 4&jlii 0) ly £jj} iLord of the east and the west, and all that is between them, if you did but understand!} 'He is the One Who made the east the place where the heavenly bodies rise, and made the west the place where they set; this is the system to which He has subjugated all the heavenly bodies, stationary and moving. If what Fir'awn claims is true, that he is your lord and your god, then let him turn things around so that the heavenly bodies set in the east and rise in the west.' This is similar to the Ayah, if iij h d\$S\ iii iii; J 4 iji O/Jj' O?* Jfi J «,^l lit Jfi <Z*-+£J iwho disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord, because Allah had given him the kingdom? When Ibrahim said: "My Lord is He Who gives life and causes death." He said, "I give life and cause death." Ibrahim said, "Verily, Allah brings the sun from the east. So cause it to rise from the west." (2:258) So when Fir'awn was defeated in debate, he resorted to the use of his force and power, believing that this would be effective in dealing with Musa, peace be upon him, so he said, as Allah tells us:

jtt ^5 . j# J6 o&t oO J6^ i"iT *£?<** -5 (^iC > . 'iff ^ ,f > ^ *£*&? '\$ •Wafr *^=» *2\$ p-^ssuiyJ tJ -bj* <X^,£jp _/*l—1 Ulfc oj dj>- JU J^=o — C^JJ j *U3j 4*-J i_pLi jip^LiXj^* ^L ^2^ fIC, 429. He said: "If you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners. 430. He said: "Even if I bring you something manifest?"} 431. He said: "Bring it forth then, if you are of the truthful!"} 432. So he threw his stick, and behold, it was a serpent, manifest.} 433 . And he drew out his hand, and behold, it was white to all beholders!} 434. He said to the chiefs around him: "Verily, this is indeed a well-versed sorcerer."} 435. "He wants to drive you out of your land by his sorcery:

what is it then that you command?"}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4090–4103]

436. They said: "Put him off and his brother (for a while), and send callers to the cities;" } 437. "To bring up to you every well-versed sorcerer."} After the Rational Proof, Fir'awn resorts to Force When proof had been established against Fir'awn, clearly and rationally, he resorted to using force against MQsa, thinking that after this there would be no further room for discussion. So he said: 4iT'1-~ ^ Ot *£j& ojiicl

iff you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners.} To this, Musa responded: ic*? t&i ')\$} iEven if I bring you something manifest?} meaning, clear and definitive proof.

sJpCCs? 6U5 Ct 4Fir'awn said: "Bring it forth then i/yoH are of the truthful!" So he threw his stick, and behold, it was a serpent, manifest.} meanig, it was very clear and obvious, with a huge body and a big mouth, terrifying in appearance. <rt 4And he drew out his hand,} meaning, from his sleeve, iand behold, it was white to all beholders!} It was shining like a piece of the moon. Since Fir'awn was already doomed, he hastened to stubborn denial, and said to the chiefs around him: iVerily, this is indeed a well-versed sorcerer.} One who knows a great deal of magic or witchcraft. Fir'awn was trying to convince them that this was sorcery, not a miracle. Then he provoked them against Musa, trying to make them oppose him and disbelieve in him, and said: 4He wants to drive you out of your land by his sorcery. . .} meaning, *he wants to capture the people's hearts and win them over by doing this, so that they will support him, and help him and follow him, and he will defeat you in your own land and take the land from you. So advise me, what should I do with him?' j tZSy ££ 4They said "Put him off and his brother, and send callers to the cities; to bring up to you every well-versed sorcerer."} meaning, 'delay him and his brother until you gather together all the sorcerers from every city and region of your kingdom so that they may confront him and produce something like he produces, then you will defeat him and have the victory.' So Fir'awn did as they suggested, which is what Allah decreed

225Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (38 - 48) (Part-19) rn £l U3 jls\$ u'y \$c&&\ 0^\£p#£0U^i&"Jfo0 0 tfflVSi) J1 ^jSf^y^J ^l^jl?^^ £"pfj&Sjj&0pJfJ9-^a?(4^ D^^ Cp ^oi all :^5t3V>a would happen to them, so that all the people would gather in one place and the signs and proof of Allah would be made manifest before them all in one day. jOi '~ ' ^ ^>%) } j* o;t5 jj» oi ^tou LUJ ^p^OyyjZ £. llii ,ti i^f u y s>jjj ys (*- ** oj :\$;S£; *5 H\$^ i/%. ^ ;< ojii!' uj*>> t Jot ^ fry lz& 'jk f'oj^i: ^ ..V 1 Isrj* *ji> -iy. L>U jj)li . 'J^y 438. So, the sorcerers were assembled at a fixed time on a day appointed.} 439. And it was said to the people: "Are you (too) going to assemble?"} 440. "That we may follow the sorcerers if they are the winners."} 441 . So, when the sorcerers arrived, they said to Fir'awn "Will there surely be a reward for us if we are the winners?"} 442. He said: "Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near (to myself)." } 443. Musa said to them: "Throw what you are going to

throw!"} 444. So, they threw their ropes and their sticks, and said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win!"} 445. Then Musa threw his stick, and behold, it swallowed up all that they falsely showed!} 446. And the sorcerers fell down prostrate.} 447. Saying: "We believe in the Lord of Al-'Alamin ." } 448. "The Lord of Musa and Hariin." } Between Musa, peace be upon him, and the Sorcerers Allah describes the actual encounter between Musa, peace be upon him, and the Egyptians in Surat Al-A'raf, Surah Ta Ha, 11 and in this Surah. The Egyptians wanted to extinguish the Light of Allah with their words, but Allah insisted that His Light should prevail even though the disbelievers disliked that. This is the issue of disbelief and faith; they never confront one another but faith always prevails: tL Jiji' '4 4Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it disappears. And woe to you for that which you ascribe.} (21:18) /Ct •A SSSf - m 4And say: "Truth has come and falsehood has vanished." } (17:81) The sorcerers of Egypt were the most skilled in the art of illusion, but when a huge group of them gathered from all corners of the land, and the people came together on that day whose exact numbers are kn<^j>n to Allah Alone, one of them said: jt* \yjfc a) •/

*£.ii 4That we may follow the sorcerers if they are the winners.} See volume four, Surat Al-A'raf (7 : 79-82), and volume six, Surah TaHa{20:59-76).

Sarah 26. Ash-Shu'ara' (38 - 48) (Part-19) 227 They did not say: 'We will follow the truth, whether it rests with the sorcerers or with Musa;' the people were followers of the religion of their king. £&} ^So, when the sorcerers arrived, means, when they reached the court of Fir'awn, and a pavilion had been erected for him. There he gathered his servants, followers, administrators, and provincial leaders, and the soldiers of his kingdom. The sorcerers stood before Fir'awn, asking him to treat them well and bring them closer to him if they prevailed in this matter which he had brought them together for. They said: i"Will there surely be a reward for us if we are the winners?" He said: "Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near."} meaning, 'and you will be given more than what you are asking for; I will make you among those who are close to me, those who sit with me.' So they went back to their places: 4jyll St JtS <>* O' ty }They said : "O Musa! Either you throw first or we be the first to throw?" (Musa) said: "Nay, throw you (first)!"} (20:65- 66). Here the incident is described more briefly. Musa said to them: i"Throw what you are going to throw!" So, they threw their ropes and their sticks, and said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win!"} This is what the ignorant masses say when they do something: This is by the virtue of So-and-so!' In Surat Al-A'raf Allah mentioned that they: iThey bewitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them, and they displayed a great magic} (7:116). And in Surah TaHa He said:

\$ 'fijv (a Sh piCs iThen behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they moved fast until Allah saying: i3 g%} iand the magician will never be successful, whatever the amount (of skill) he may attain} {20:69). And here Allah says: i l* <—iih ^ liji iThen Musa threw his stick, and behold, it swallowed up all that they falsely showed!} by snatching up and catching them from every corner and swallowing them up, and it did not leave any of them untouched. Allah says: i&sfz u &&} iThus truth was confirmed, and all that they did was made of no effect.} until ^ ^j} iThe Lord of Miisd and Harun.} (7:118-122) This was a very serious matter, furnishing decisive proof leaving no room for any excuse. Fir'awn's supporters, who sought and hoped that they would prevail over Mtisa, were themselves defeated. At that moment they believed in Musa and prostrated to Allah, the Lord of Al-'Alamin Who sent Musa and H&rGn with the truth and an obvious miracle. Fir'awn was defeated in a manner the likes of which the world had never seen, but he remained arrogant and stubborn despite the clear evidence, may the curse of Allah and the angels and all of mankind be upon him. He resorted to arrogance and stubbornness and propagating falsehood. He began to issue threats against them, saying: pi '\$p& iVerily, he is your chief who has taught you magic} (20:71).

j, 'JZ& l} iSurely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city^ (7:123). Spi 3^ ^ ssc g 35 £ jlit; Gjj dj ® J** ^ fgg jjt if gtga (2; e j£ gg 449. He said: "You have believed in him before I give you leave. Surely, he indeed is your chief, wlv has taught you magic! So verily, you shall come to know. Verily, I will cut off your hands and your feet on opposite sides, and I will crucify you all."} 450 . They said: "No harm! Surely, to our Lord we are to return."} 452. "Verily, we really hope that our Lord will forgive us our sins, as we are the first of the believers."} Between Fir'awn and the Sorcerers His threats against them resulted only in an increase in their faith and submission to Allah, for the veil of disbelief had been lifted from their hearts and the truth became clear to them because they knew something that their

people did not: that what Musa had done could not have been done by any human being unless Allah helped him, making it proof and an evidence of the truth of what he had brought from his Lord. Then Fir'awn said to them: ip 3£ \$p:} iYou have believed in him before I give you leave.} meaning, *you should have asked my permission for what you did, and you did not consult with me; if I had given you permission you could have done it, and if I did not allow you, you should not have done it, for I am the ruler and the one to be obeyed.' ipfi 'p& iSurely, he indeed is your chief, who has taught you magic!}

458. Treasures, and every kind of honorable place.} 459. Thus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.} The Exodus of the Children of Israel from Egypt After Musa stayed in Egypt for a long time, and the proof of Allah was established against Fir'awn and his chiefs, yet they were still arrogant and stubborn, then there was nothing left for them but punishment and vengeance. So Allah commanded Musa, peace be upon him, to take the Children of Israel out of Egypt by night, and take them wherever he would be commanded. So Musa, peace be upon him, did as he was commanded by his Lord, may He be glorified, and he led them forth after they had borrowed an abundance of jewelry from the people of Fir'awn. As more than one of the scholars of Tafsir have said, they left when the moon was rising, and Mujahid, may Allah have mercy on him, said that the moon was eclipsed that night. 1 11 And Allah knows best. Mhsa asked about the grave of Yusuf (Prophet Joseph), peace be upon him, and an old woman from among the Children of Israel showed him where it was, so he took the remains with them, and it was said that they were among the things that were carried by Musa himself, may peace be upon them both. It was also said that Yusuf, peace be upon him, had left instructions in his will that if the Children of Israel ever left Egypt, they should take his remains with them.12 The following morning, when there was nobody to be found in the Israelite quarters, Fir'awn became angry and his anger intensified since Allah had decreed that he was to be destroyed. So he quickly sent his callers to all his cities, i.e., to mobilize his troops and bring them together, and he called out to them: 4Verily, these} meaning, the Children of Israel, 4i>)4 Z&fr At-Tabari 19:354. 121 At-Tabari 19:354.

^indeed are but a small band.} meaning, a small group. 4And verily, they have done what has enraged us.} means, 'every time we have heard anything about them, it has upset us and made us angry.' 4But we are a host all assembled, amply forewarned.} means, *we are constantly taking precautions lest they betray us.' Some of the Salaf read this with the meaning, "we are constantly forewarned and forearmed. And I want to destroy them to the last man, and destroy all their lands and property." So he and his troops were punished with the very things he sought to inflict upon the Children of Israel. Allah says: 'l'?£> 4So, We expelled them from gardens and springs, treasures, and every kind of honorable place.} meaning, they were thrown out of those blessings and into Hell, and they left behind the honorable places, gardens and rivers, wealth, provision, position and power in this world: iThus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.} This is like the Ayat jfXT4^ <<4\ C'Jj} 4And We made the people who were considered weak to inherit the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed} (7:137). 4And We wished to do a favor to those who were weak in the land, and to make them rulers and to make them the inheritors} The two Ayat thereafter: [28:5-6].

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3sotff ffv puv vstjpy pscws 3/vj puy 59^ 4'3ov\ d)viff 0} SJ3iffO 31/; JV3U iqEnoxq 3/w usqi pg} 4'uw)unoui sZnq 3j/i/ 3iuv33q pvd sfvuvdss tpdv puv 'pdfxvd 11 puy „^pffS xnoR tffiai vss 3i/; 3J/ u;s,, : (SuiRvs) ysnny 0; p3v3cm 3/vi ioi/j, '£9^ i/;;m Rjusa 'Rvpi,, :pws (ysnw) Z9\$ 4,,U3^V}J3aO sq 0; sxtis 3xv 3/V4,, :pi»s »s»^v /o suotuvdutoj 3tff 'xsiffo ipvs ows sfsoq omi 3i/; U3i/m puy • jg^ 4'3SIXUHS IV Ul3lff pdnsxnd Rsiff 'os 09\$ js ^ a It 'r 5- ' ' - 'i, M r*r l r* ifOr\ rjss s! <&f & ^ it* hntr j££ js£ i?T #T3. If? f-fi f ?C >t rC# jr^- \$r irrr^ b <\$fr* !P -?j 4,, '3ut spin8 Him 3f/ -pxoq Rui si 3iu m 6l-V»d) {89 - 09)WmSW '93W

to strike the sea with his staff, so he struck it, and it parted, by the will of Allah. Allah says: 4And it parted, and each separate part became like huge mountain.} meaning, like mighty mountains. This was the view of Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others. 11 ' 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said, "It refers to a pass between two mountains." Ibn 'Abbas said, "The sea divided into twelve paths, one for each of the tribes." 2 ' As- Suddi added, "And in it there were windows through which they could see one another, and the water was erected like walls." 3 ' Allah sent the wind to the sea bed to make it solid like the land. Allah says: iand strike a dry pathfor them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken nor being afraid (20:77). And here He says: iThen We brought near the others to that place.} Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi said: iThen We brought near} means, "We brought Fir'awn and his troops near to the sea." 4 ' yj fry i^j,} }And We saved Musa and all those with him. Then We drowned the others.} meaning: *We saved Musa and the Children of Israel and whoever followed their religion, and none of them were 111 At-Jabari 19:358. '2| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :299 131 At-Tabari 19:357. |4' At-Jabari 19:359.

destroyed, but Fir'awn and his troops were drowned and not one of them remained alive, but was destroyed.' Then Allah says: 4&S j >[} iVerily, in this is indeed a sign,} meaning, this story with its wonders and tales of aid to the believing servants of Allah is definitive proofand evidence ofAllah's wisdom. 2%&@^ J3SI of iyet most of them are not believers. And verily your Lord, He is truly the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.}

The explanation of this phrase has already been discussed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4103–4104]

above.' 1 ' U Ulil x2 {yltt C <5tt H ^ kiy j* yii 3Jy&ll Ji Jli & @53 & il^ jti jujT 4@os-£5' vj 4 ^69. And recite to than the story ofIbrahim. 470. When he said to his father and his people: "What do you worship?"} 471. They said: "We worship idols, and to them we are ever devoted."} 472. He said: "Do they hear you when you call?"} 473. "Or do they benefit you or do they cause harm?"} 474. They said: "(Nay) but wefound ourfathers doing so."} 475. He said: "Do you observe that which you have been worshipping -"} 476. "You and your ancientfathers?"} 477. "Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of Al- 'Alamin,"} [i] SeeAyah no. 9 ofthis Surah.

How the Close Friend of Allah, Ibrahim spoke out

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4104–4111]

against Shirk Here Allah tells us about His servant, Messenger and Close Friend, Ibrahim, upon him be peace, the leader of the pure monotheists. Allah commanded His Messenger Muhammad jg to recite this story to his Ummah so that they could follow this example of sincerity towards Allah, putting one's trust in Him, worshipping Him Alone with no partner or associate, and renouncing Shirk and its people. Allah granted guidance to Ibrahim before, i.e., from a very early age he had denounced his people's practice of worshipping idols with Allah, may He be exalted. iWheti he said to his father and his people: "What do you worship?" meaning: what are these statues to which you are so devoted? 4 Li jit* liuJ jlu iThey said: "We worship idols, and to them we are ever devoted." meaning: we are devoted to worshipping them and praying to them. fa: yti iHe said: "Do they hear you when you call? Or do they benefit you or do they cause harm?" They said: "(Nay) but we found our fathers doing so." They knew that their idols could not do anything, but they had seen their fathers doing this, so they made haste to follow in their footsteps. So Ibrahim said to them: <r>j *1 d J-* U ^tO'r 4Do you observe that which you have been worshipping -you and your ancient fathers? Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of Al-'Alamm.}

made it a Word lasting among his offspring, that they may turn back (43:26-28). meaning: "La. tiaha lUalldh." 'ip .>> J! 1 v 478. Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me . 479. And it is He Who feeds me and gives me to drink.4 480. And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me. 481 . And Who will cause me to die, and then will bring me to life. 482. And Wlw, 1 hope, will forgive me my faults on the Day of Recompense. Ibrahim mentions Allah's Kindness towards Him Ibrahim said, "I will not worship any but the One Who does these things: 4Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me. He is the Creator Who has decreed certain things to which He guides His creation, so each person follows the path which is decreed for him. Allah is the One Who guides whomsoever He wills and leaves astray whomsoever He wills. 4And it is He Who feeds me and gives me to drink.4 He is my Creator Who provides for me from that which He has made available in the heavens and on earth. He drives the clouds and causes water to fall with which He revives the earth and brings forth its fruits as provision for mankind. He sends down the water fresh and sweet so that many of those whom He has created, animals and men alike, may drink from it. 4And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me. Here he attributed sickness to himself, even though it is Allah

^ iKSffig rv ' mtSSP ^ i^<> -"tf ">'<£<* ' '>:.*"Xi ':\&> .- 0 03£*5 o^% ^10V^oj3Ssit3^ 0sjSSjVi^i^ Tafctr Ibn Kathir •MX ^saWho decrees it, out of respect towards Allah. By the same token, Allah commands us to say in the prayer, «(|££\$ iGuide us to the straight way} (1:6) to the end of the Surah. Grace and guidance are attributed to Allah, may He be exalted, but the subject of the verb with reference to anger is omitted, and going astray is attributed to the people. This is like when the Jinn said: t| t>*j -*y* jr*" V f& n 4 >1 jj>jVf 4A«d u>e know not whether evil is intended for those on earth, or whether their Lord intends for them a right path (72:10) Similarly, Ibrahim said: {And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me.} meaning, "when I fall sick, no one is able to heal me but Him, Who heals me with the means that may lead to recovery'. r«^> < y Who will cause me to die, and then will bring me to life.} He is the One Who gives life and causes death, and no one besides Him is able to do that, for He is the One Who originates and repeats.

j>y_ J Afi ^ 4And Who, I hope, will forgive me my faults on the Day of Recompense.} means, no one is able to forgive sins in this world or the Hereafter except Him. Who can forgive sins except Allah? For He is the One Who does whatever He wills. pt "if 0}& Pi tfL &> if ^ ^ j* if *^1 483. My Lord! Bestow Hukm on me, and join me with the righteous.} 484. And grant me an honorable mention in later generations.} 485. And make me one of the inheritors of the Paradise of Delight.} 486. Andforgive my father, verily, he is of the erring.} 487. And disgrace me not on the Day when they will be resurrected.} 488. The Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail,} 489. Except him who brings to Allah a clean heart.} The Prayer ofIbrahim for Himselfand for His Father Here Ibrahim, upon him be peace, asks his Lord to give him Hukm. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This is knowledge.” 4cr~^iA. ,ji*Aj} 4and join me with the righteous.} means, ‘make me one of the righteous in this world and the Hereafter.’ This is like the words

the Prophet said three times when he was dying: 'J& * J=#'J «0 Allah, with the Exalted Companion (ofParadise)*j2 4 4 oO j *** Al-Baghawi 3 :390 121 Path Al-Bdri 7 :743

iAnd grant me an honorable mention in later generations.} meaning, ‘cause me to be remembered in a good manner after my death, so that I will be spoken of and taken as a good example.’ This is like the Ayah, iAnd We left for him (a goodly remembrance) among the later generations: "Saldm (peace) be upon Ibrahim. Thus indeed do we reward the good doers.} (37:108-110) iAnd make me one of the inheritors of the Paradise ofDelight.} meaning, *bless me in this world with honorable mention after I am gone, and in the Hereafter by making me one of the inheritors of the Paradise of Delight.’ <3 4Andforgive myfather,} This is like the Ayah, i&j&j J 'jp'&j} \$My Lord! Forgive me, and my parents} (71:28). But this is something which Ibrahim, peace be upon him, later stopped doing, as Allah says: fSy if Cj} iAnd Ibrahim's supplication far his father's forgiveness was only because ofa promise he had made to him} (9:1 14) until: i^L lI} iVerily, Ibrahim wasAwwdh111 andwasforbearing} (9:1 14). Allah stopped Ibrahim from asking for forgiveness for his father, as He says: 'So 1+fA '4 p& 15} ilndeed there has been an excellent example far you in Ibrahim and those with him}, until His saying: m See volume four , the Tafsir of SuratAt-Tawbah (9:114).

&\$&& <i3p1 ibnt I have no power to do anything for you before Allah.} (60:4), . ft. iAnd disgrace me not on the Day when they will be resurrected.} means, “protect me from shame on the Day of Resurrection and the Day when all creatures, the first and the last, will be raised.’ Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet sg said: aJLp »Ut (_>tj \ jl oIbrahim will see his father on the Day of Resurrection, covered with dust and darkness. According to another narration, also from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, the Prophet sfe said: jy& ijjiil’ yf,m y >iit dtf* '-r’j 'i '• iIbrahim will meet his father and will say: "O Lord, You promised me that You would not disgrace me on the Day when all creatures are resurrected." And Allah will say to him: "I haveforbidden Paradise to the disbelievers."^ He also recorded this in the Hadiths about the Prophets, upon them be peace, where the wording is: «j=> jj' 9rj ‘V1^ \y. jj’ Zjj U 'J JjZ* > V Jli jit ill JyCi jilS/l Jf j* t5^»-t ^ti (ji jks™ y j' o->*J ‘faj\ U : JliJ Ai»Jl t##! fJliJl^ Jb-Js* 3* bji * * # # ^Ibrahim will meet his father Azar on the Day of Resurrection, 111 Fath Al-Bdri 8 :357 121 Fath Al-Bdri 8 :357.

244 Tafslr Ibn Kathir and there will be dust and darkness on Azar's face. Ibrahim will say to him, "Did I not tell you not to disobey me?" His father will say to him: “Today I will not disobey you." Ibrahim will

say: "O Lord, You promised me that You would not disgrace me on the Day when they are resurrected, but what disgrace can be greater than seeing my father in this state?" Allah will say to him: "I have forbidden Paradise to the disbelievers." Then it will be said: "O Ibrahim! Look beneath your feet." So he will look and there he will see (that his father was changed into) a male hyena covered in dung, which will be caught by the legs and thrown in the Fire.¹¹¹¹ This was also recorded by Abu 'Abdur-Rahman An-Nasa'i in

the Tafsir of his Sunan Al-Kubra.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4111]

{2} 4103* ^ 4The Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail,} means, a man's wealth will not protect him from the punishment of Allah, even if he were to pay a ransom equivalent to an earthful of gold. <&& inor sons} means, 'or if you were to pay a ransom of all the people on earth.' On that Day nothing will be of any avail except faith in Allah and sincere devotion to Him, and renunciation of Shirk and its people. Allah says: 410;*^** yli jf^{} iExcept him who brings to Allah a clean heart.} meaning, free from any impurity or Shirk. Ibn Sirin said, "The clean heart knows that Allah is true, that the Hour will undoubtedly come and that Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves."¹³¹ Said bin Al-Musayyib said, "The clean heart is the sound heart."¹⁴¹ This is the heart of the believer, for the heart of the disbeliever and the hypocrite is sick. Allah says: Fath Al-Bari 6:445. This was previously explained in volume three,

the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ana'm (6 :79)

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121 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:422 At-Tabari 19:366. 141 Al-Baghawi 3:390.

jou auv tuaqi fo }sout iaR 'uSts v paapui si stip ui 'Rjua/^ '£01) f.jsuaaa,ipq aqi 8uouiv aq R\tui \\vqs am. 'uuttjau o) aoutnp v pvq Rjuo am f\ Qstqy),, ZOL i,, 'pw>ufasop v jon,, ioi 4,/sjossaauijui ou aovq am mopq,, 00l) 4,/SVUllUU3 aip jdaaxa uouua 0}ui sn iq2nouq svq auou puy,, gg) i,/s)stxa imp ip fo puoq aip ipim spnba sv noR pjaq am uaq/^zilt -ggp 4'uouua isafiuvtu v ui R\rui axam am 'qvpv Rq,, zg) 4'utajaifl Suipuaiuoo apqm Rvs pirn Ram ggp i'uaqiaSoi sijqjfo sisoq aqi/o pv puy 4'Rvuisv aip puv Raqi '(autj aqi) ji o;ui saavf utaqi uo umoiqi aq pirn Ratp uaqi fgp i'^saaiauijui d{aq jo noR dpq Raqi uvj iqppy fo pvaisuj,, -£g\$ i'/diqsuom o) pasti noR imp asoqi auv auaq/w,, : tuaqi o) ptvs aq ptm p puy Z6) 4'Rvuisv aqi fo mam ptif ui paov{d aq pirn auj (pan) aqi puy • ig\$ 4'vmbv pvq oqm asoqi °1 wau iqSnoj aq pim asipvuvj puy '06) ..IfBUUnS 3ip iptM 1U3JU00 SI PUB UOpBAOUUl UIOJJ aajj si iBip vreaq aip si 'pres unqBsyj-uv u?tuipfL nqy '(Ol S) iasvasip v si sfuvaq upqi uft SPZ {6l~1Jvd) (POL - 06) ,m,nqs-qsy gz qvjJS

f JldJl)&)) 4And all of the hosts of blis together.) they will all be thrown into it. 4They will say while contending therein, "By Allah, we were truly in a manifest error, when we held you as equals with the Lord of all that exists.") The weak ones among them will say to their arrogant leaders: Verily, we were following you; can you avail us anything from the Fire?' Then they will realize that themselves are to blame and will say: i) £& 4 \$s) 4By Allah, we were truly in a manifest error, when we held you as

equals with the Lord of all that exists.) meaning, “we obeyed your commands as we should have obeyed the commands of the Lord of the all that exists, and we worshipped you along with the Lord of all that exists.’ uti Zj) 4And none has brought us into error except the criminals.) meaning, “nobody called us to do that except the evildoers.’ 4Now we have no intercessors.) This is like the Ayah which tells us that they will say: La i Jp Ji U Ijn.4^U *LtJut ij* U 4--now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back so that we might do deeds other than those deeds which we used to do?) (7:53). Similarly, in this Surah, Allah tells us that they will say: 4Now we have no intercessors, nor a close friend.)

248 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4(Alas!) If we only had a chance to return, we shall truly be among the believers!} They will wish that they could come back to this world so that they could do deeds of obedience to their Lord - as they claim - but Allah knows that if they were to come back to this world, they would only go back to doing forbidden things, and He knows that they are liars. Allah tells us in Surah Sad about how the people of Hell will argue with one another, as He says: >' l\} iVerily, that is the very truth - the mutual dispute of the people of the Fire!} (38:64) Then He says: iVerily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} meaning, in the dispute of Ibrahim with his people and his proof of Tawhid there is a sign, i.e., clear evidence that there is no God but Allah. iyet most of them are not believers. And verily, your Lord, He is truly the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} 04&P 4l \$\$\$ \$&& ?X h iil \J& Je V) Lb4 Oi Ey 4105. The people of Nilh denied the Messengers.} 4106. When their brother Nuh said to them: "Will you not have Taqwa?"} 4107. "I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4108. "So have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me."} 4109. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only

from the Lord of all that exists."} 4110. "So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me."} Null's preaching to His People, and Their Response Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Null, peace be upon him, who was the first Messenger sent by Allah to the people of earth after they started to worship idols. Allah sent him to forbid that and to warn people of the consequences of idol worship. But his people belied him and continued their evil practice of worshipping idols besides Allah. Allah revealed that their disbelieving in him was akin to disbelieving in all the Messengers, So Allah said: iThe people of Niih belied the Messengers. When their brother Niih said to them: "Will you not have Taqwd?"} meaning, 'do you not fear Allah when you worship others instead of Him?' 4:\$t-U&&p 4/ am a trustworthy Messenger to you.} means, I am the Messenger of Allah to you, faithfully fulfilling the mission with which Allah has sent me. I convey the Messages of my Lord to you, and I do not add anything to them or take anything away from them., Lt& jgfd % 'it \$&} 4So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me. No reward do I ask of you for it;} means, I do not want any payment for the advice I give you; I will save my reward for it with Allah.' it \y&} 4So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me.} It is clear to you that I am telling the truth and that I am faithfully fulfilling the mission with which Allah has entrusted me.'

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‘noA ui 3A3ipq puB noA Moqoj oqm ‘ajdoad sqi jo issuBsui sqi oi psnbs stuoosq puB noA avoiipj iou niM puB ‘noA ui 3A3ipq iou op 3/w,, :pres Asqj, asuodsaxam P«® quN jo aidaj aqjjo puBuiaa sqx ^•usuuvon uwid v R\uo rnv /,, -silt 4/sudastpq sip Rvcnv saup oj SuioS IOU uw I puy,, fil> 4,/motq (piq) pinoo noli ft ‘puo’j Rui ipica R\uo si lunooov Apia,, ‘£IZ> i,,i°P o) pssn Imp ivqm fo l 3am{ 3%pd\ (noun ivqoi puy,, :p}»s 3H ‘Zll> i..t°R cnonof uousfui dip usqcn ‘noR ut sasipq sm ims,, V vs fan • III> a^ tK # % f. ra a £\ 1? ff- <9fi ffi «r Star umivyi uqi uis/vx OSZ

252Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (111 - 122) (Part-19) accept it if they believe in me; whatever is in their hearts is for Allah to know.’ iTheir account is only with my Lord, ifyou could (but) know. And I am not going to drive away the believers.} It seems that they asked him to drive these people away, then they would follow him, but he refused to do that, and said: 4 %a jdk \$o iAnd I am not going to drive away the believers. I am only a plain wamer.} meaning, *1 have been sent as a wamer, and whoever obeys me and follows me and believes in me, then he belongs to me and I to him, whether he is noble or common, upper-class or lower-class.’ 4* C*U ‘•l VJ Jt Ot£=J {fk *ku y ^ 4 J2&& & (3£ 4^ »4j ojS Cites* Cj 4 M tip 4116. They said: "Ifyou cease not, O Nuh you will surely be among those stoned."} 4117. He said: "My Lord! Verily, my people have denied me."} 4118. "Therefore judge You between me and them, and save me and those of the believers who are with me."} 4119. And We saved him and those with him in the laden ship.} 4120. Then We drowned the rest thereafter.} 4121. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4122 . And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.}

253Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (123 - 135) (Part-19) believers. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} 4123. ‘Ad denied the Messengers.} 4124. When their brother Hud said to them: “Will you not have Taqwa?”} 4125. "Verily , I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4126. "So, have Taqwa ofAllah, and obey me."} 4127. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord of all that exists."} 4128. "Do you build on every Rt an Ayah for your amusement?"} 4129. "And do you get for yourselves Masdni' as if you will live therein forever?"} 4130. "And when you seize (somebody), seize you Qxim) as tyrants?"} 4131. "So have Taqwa ofAllah, and obey me."} 4132. "And have Taqwa ofHim, fear Him Who has aided you with all (good things) that you know."} 4133. "He has aided you with cattle and children."} 4134. "And gardens and springs."} 4135. "Verily, Ifearfor you the torment ofa Great Day."} Hud’s preaching to His People ‘Ad Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Hud, when he called his people ‘Ad. His people used to live in the Ahqaf curved sand-hills near Hadramawt, on the borders of Yemen. They lived after the time of Nuh, as Allah says in Surat Al-A'r&f.

255Surah 26. Ash-Shu‘ara' (135 - 140) (Part-19) rvr X •/>» j*SV> 1 1 >"»£•’< •:. ^ •> >1*>T Up Up •" **'<&> *>' . \i4as if you will live therein forever^ means, ‘so that you may stay there forever, but that is not going to hap- pen, because they will eventually cease to be, just as happened in the case of those who came before you.’ AiU^a-XIA ^Antf when you seize (somebody), seize you (him) as tyrants?} They are described as being strong, violent and tyrannical. i*fSy \£%) iSo, have Tacfwa of Allah, and obey me.> ‘Worship your Lord and obey your Messenger.’ Then Hud began reminding them of the blessings that Allah had bestowed upon them. He said: xj>\ oy^f /J L, ifjJi ^ £& iAnd have Taqiva ofHim, Who has aided you with all that you know. He has aided you with cattle and children, and

gardens and springs. Verily, I fear for you the tontient of a Great Day.} meaning, *if you disbelieve and oppose (your Prophet).’ So he called them to Allah with words of encouragement and words of warning, but it was to no avail. o* ty yu. ^1 <\$1 2 \$ %\$ SP

'iLL L.J *J"Sf (4 0] 4P~ ^236 . They said: "It is the same to us whether you preach or be not of those who preach."} 4137. "This is no other than Khuluq of the ancients,"} 4138. "And we are not going to be punished."} 4139. So they denied him, and We destroyed them. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4140. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the Almighty, the Most Merciful.} The Response of the People of Hud, and Their Punishment Allah tells us how the people of Hud responded to him after he had warned them, encouraged them, and clearly explained the truth to them. 4They said: "It is the same to us whether you preach or be not of those who preach."} meaning, “we will not give up our ways.’ 4And we shall not leave our gods far your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you} (1 :53). This is how it was, as Allah says: 4Verily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe} (2 :6). 4Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe} (10 :96-97). And they said:

<77ns is no other than Khuluq of the ancients.) Some scholars read this: “Khalq”. According to Ibn Mas‘ud and according to ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas - as reported from Al-‘Awfi - and ‘Alqamah and Mujahid, they meant, “What you have brought to us is nothing but the tales (Akhlāq) of the ancients.”¹¹¹ This is like what the idolaters of Quraysh said: iAnd they say : "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon.") (25:5) And Allah said: jA*- -Ail pi ije ‘Aj/it t£li[^ Til* u) f jlij^ Jjkd ijiiij :h<£> iThose who disbelieve say: "This is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him in it. In fact, they have produced an injustice and a lie." And they say: "Tales of the ancients..." (25:4-5) i^<Z\$R pk jj iAnd when it is said to them : "What is it that your Lord has sent down?" They say: "Tales of the ancient!") (16:24). Some other scholars recited it. 'Ji Ui iThis is no other than Khuluq of the ancients,) “as Khuluq,” meaning their religion. What they were following was the religion of the ancients, their fathers and grandfathers, as if they were saying: “We are following them, we will live as they lived and die as they died, and there will be no resurrection and no judgement.” Hence they said: m At-Tabari 19:378.

258 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 4And we are not going to be punished . Allah’s saying; 4S0 they denied him, and We destroyed them.} meaning, they continued to disbelieve and stubbornly oppose Allah’s Prophet Hud, so Allah destroyed them. The means of their destruction has been described in more than one place in the Qur’an: Allah sent against them a strong and furious wind, i.e., a fiercely blowing wind that was intensely cold. Thus the means of their destruction was suited to their nature, for they were the strongest and fiercest of people, so Allah overpowered them with something that was even stronger and fiercer than them, as Allah says: 4Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with ‘Ad of Iram? Possesors of the pillars} (89:6-7). This refers to the former ‘Ad, as Allah says: 4 JjVi 'jU \$3} 4And that it is He Who destroyed thefarmer ‘Ad (53:50). They were descendents of Iram bin Sam bin Nuh, 4>a^} 4Possesors of the pillars} They used to live among pillars. Those who claim that Iram was a city take this idea from Isra’ttiyyat 1 ’ narrations, from the words of KaT> and Wahb, but there is no real basis for that. Allah says: 4The like ofwhich were not created in the land} (89:8). meaning, nothing like this tribe was created in terms of might, power and tyranny. If what was meant was a city, it would have

said, "The like of which was not built in the land." And Allah says: 28 dA !£M% U &\ z \)ij \$. \ Jfa %&} ' | See the author's introduction to volume one.

4As for 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?" See they not that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them. And they used to deny Our Ayat!} (41:15) And Allah says: 4And as for 'Ad, they were destroyed by a furious violent wind!} until His saying: 4tji~} 4in succession (69:6-7) meaning, consecutively (i.e., seven nights and eight days). cj\$ —is*} iso that you could see men lying overthrown (destroyed), as if they were hollow trunks of date palms!} (69:7) means, they were left as headless bodies, because the wind would come and carry one of them, then drop him on his head, so that his brains were spilled out, his head was broken and he was thrown aside, as if they were uprooted stems of date-palms. They used to build fortresses in the mountains and caves, and they dug ditches half as deep as a man is tall, but that did not help them against the command of Allah at all. *£ %U£ iVerily, the term given by Allah, when it comes, cannot be delayed (71:4). Allah says here: 4So they denied him, and We destroyed them.} 4141. Thamud denied the Messengers.}

A Reminder to Them of their Circumstances and the Blessings They enjoyed Salih preached to them, warning them that the punishment of Allah could overtake them and reminding them of the blessings that Allah had bestowed upon them, by giving them ample provision and making them safe from all kinds of dangers, giving them gardens and flowing springs, and bringing forth for them crops and fruits. iand date palms with soft clusters. } Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, "Ripe and rich."111 'Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that this meant growing luxuriantly. Ismail bin Abi Khalid narrated from 'Amr bin Abi 'Amr - who met the Companions - from Ibn 'Abbas that this means, "When it becomes ripe and soft." This was narrated by Ibn Abi Hatim, then he said: "And something similar was narrated from Abu \$alih." iAtid you hew out in the mountains, houses with great skill.} Ibn 'Abbas and others said, "With great skill."*2 * According to another report from him: "They were greedy and extravagant." This was the view of Mujahid and another group.*3 * There is no contradiction between the two views, because they built the houses which they carved in the mountains as a form of extravagant play, with no need for them as dwelling places. They were highly skilled in the arts of masonry and stone- carving, as is well known to anyone who has seen their structures. So, Salih said to them: iSo, have Taqwd of AllBi\, and obey me.} Pay attention to that which could benefit you in this world and the Hereafter; worshipping your Lord Who created you, who Fath Al-Bdri 7 :731 . See the Tafstrof Surat Al-A'r€if[7 -.79) ' At-Tabari 19:380. ' At-Tabari 19:382. At-Tabari 19:383.

263Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ara' (153 - 159) (Part-19) witchcraft." * Then they said: iYou are but a human being like us.} meaning, "how can you receive Revelation when we do not?" This is like the Ayah where they are described as saying: 'VI 4"Is it that the Reminder is sent to him alonefrom among us? Nay, he is an insolent liar!" Tomorrow they will come to know who is the liar, the insolent one!} (54:26-27) Then they asked him for a sign to prove that what he brought to them from their Lord was the truth. A crowd of them gathered and demanded that he immediately bring forth from the rock a she-camel that was ten months pregnant, and they pointed to a certain rock in their midst. Allah's Prophet Salih made them promise that if he responded to their request, they would believe in him and follow him. So they agreed to that. The Prophet of Allah Salih, peace be upon him, stood and prayed, then he

prayed to Allah to grant them their request. Then the rock to which they had pointed split open, revealing a she-camel that was ten months pregnant, exactly as they had requested. So some of them believed, but most of them disbelieved. O - . virs « #(X a *iii 4He said: "Here is a site-camel: it has a right to drink (water), and you have a right to drink (water) (each) on a day, known.} meaning, 'she will drink from your water one day, and on the next day you will drink from it.' Hi 4And toitch her not with harm, lest the torment ofa Great Day should seize you.} He warned them of the punishment of Allah if they should do her any harm. The she-camel stayed among them for a while, drinking the water, eating leaves and grazing, and they 111 At-Tabari 19:384, 385.

i,iP(nbD£ 3aml }ou noR ///Ad,, •umg o/ pws pjq isipoiq imp ioijm igft 4'SJ3\$U3SS31A/ 3lff psiusp PJ1 fo 3\do3cl 31U 091^ 3\$ ft'3WI sa 17*1 & 1*f 5 £ ff J!^# \ ?r rfr n 15- K* c\$1 2^ ft# i'lInfpusw isow 3il} 'Rl l {°!Vi-llV 3tii p33put si 3j-j 'pjo'j inoR Rjusa puy sianoipq fou 3iv lusty fo ;soiu pR 'iiSts v psspui si snp ui 'R\U3^ <% p& h%%x? rrtf % rar&x% •sauioq Jiaqi ui aiBJjsoid 3tnXj '(peap) yaj ajaM os 'Sutpadxa iou 3J3M Aaqi qorq/A SJU3A3 Aq uajfejjao 3J3M Aaqx 'saoBjd .iraqi uiojj sjJBaq Jiaqi jjoo; qorqAA (jnoqs) ifvqfivs SutuqaqAuaAO ub uiaqi oj auiba ajaqi pire 'ajJBtibqjjBa Suojjs b Xq U33{Bqs sbm puB| Jtaqx i'uaifi yoopdao }U3tu -10} 3if) 'os 'pifpiSou 3UIV33q R.31}} U3l{ } pUV 'T3if P3JJPI Rsip pig), ssrfnc} ^7f\ uaq npi oj pajrdsuoo Aaqj 'xeau Avaap uorpruisap jraqi joj auip aqi pur? 'auqi 3uoj b joj uo auoS psq siqj jayy nU srq jjuup oj auo XJ3A3 joj saytiuBnb juaprgns ui jjooi Xaqi qotqM jqrux jaq uiojj paurjauaq ^mmmm»i ferric? Vi?*i€\$df 0 JAJ f^IttSf: f9Z

265Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (160 - 164) (Part-19) 4162. "Verily , I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4163. "So, have Taqwa ofAllah, and obey me."} 4164. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord ofall that exits."} Lut and His Call Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Lat, peace be upon him. He was Lut bin Haran bin Azar, the nephew of Ibrahim Al-Khalll, upon him be peace. Allah sent him to a mighty nation during the lifetime of Ibrahim, peace be upon them both. They lived in Sadum (Sodom) and its environs, where Allah destroyed them and turned the area into a putrid, stinking lake, which is well-known in the land of Al- Ghur (the Jordan Valley], bordering the mountains of Jerusalem, between the mountains and the land of Al-Karak and Ash-Shawbak. He called them to Allah, to worship Him alone with no partner or associate, and to obey the Messenger whom Allah sent to them. He forbade from disobeying Allah and committing the sin that they had invented which was unknown on earth before their time; intercourse with males instead of with females. Allah said: it £p, 41 36 Si\$3 & j4 gfi ^ // <4 /ft' * /ay 4 X. ./•< . K.yyy y I y.y y > .y Sty Qj 4165. "Co you in unto the males ofAl-Alamin (people),"} 4166. "And leave those whom Allah has created for you to be your wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people!"} 4167. They said: "Ifyou cease not, O Lut, verily, you will be one of those who are driven out!"} 4168. He said: "I am indeed of those who disapprove with severe anger andfury your belmvior."} 4169. "My Lord! Save me and my family from what they do."}

4170. So, We saved hint and hisfamily, all,} 4171. Except an old woman among those who remained behind.} 4172. Then afterward We destroyed the others.} 4173. And We rained on them a rain, and how evil was the rain of those who had been warned!} 4174. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4175. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} Lut's Denunciation of His People's Deeds, Their Response and Their Punishment The Prophet of Allah

forbade them from committing evil deeds and intercourse with males, and he taught them that they should have intercourse with their wives whom Allah had created for them. Their response was only to say: 4If you cease not, O hut,} meaning, 'if you do not give up what you have brought,' 4U%^ U 4verily, you will be one of those who are driven out!} meaning, *we will expel you from among us.' This is like the Ayah, o*'-^ p-fij oi -Jyl J** [f%A o' VI ClA£=> 4There was no other answer given by his people except that they said: "Drive out the family of Lut from your city. Verily, these are men who want to be clean and pure!"} (27:56). When he saw that they would not give up their ways, and that they were persisting in their misguidance, he declared his innocence of them, saying: 4I am, indeed, of those who disapprove with severe anger and

fury) 'Of those who are outraged, I do not like it and I do not accept it, and I have nothing to do with you.' Then he prayed to Allah against them and said: 4My Lord! Save me and my family from what they do.) Allah says: 4So, V\le saved him and his family, all. Except an old woman among those who remained behind.) This was his wife, who was a bad old woman. She stayed behind and was destroyed with whoever else was left. This is similar to what Allah says about them in Surat Al-A'raf and Surah Hud, and in Surat Al-Hijr} 1] where Allah commanded him to take his family at night, except for his wife, and not to turn around when they heard the Sayhah as it came upon his people. So they patiently obeyed the command of Allah and persevered, and Allah sent upon the people a punishment which struck them all, and rained upon them stones of baked clay, piled up. Allah says: 4Then afterward We destroyed the others. And We rained on them a ram> |21 until Allah's saying; 48-*^ kf) 4And verily, your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.) 4#*Pv£^& oi2*& psi tj it j& 4176. The companions of Al-Aykah denied the Messengers.) 111 See 7:80-81, 11:77, 15:58-76. ,21 That was a storm of stones. See the previous references for its explanation

268 Tafslr Ibn Kathir i!77. When Shu'ayb said to them: "Will you not have Taqwa?"} 4178. "I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4179. "So, have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me."} 4180. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord of Al-'Alamin."} Shu'ayb and His Preaching to the Dwellers of Al-Aykah The companions of Al-Aykah were the people of Madyan, according to the most correct view. The Prophet of Allah Shu'ayb was one of them, but it does not say here, their brother Shu'ayb, because they called themselves by a name denoting their deification of Al-Aykah, which was a tree which they used to worship; it was said that it was a group of trees which were tangled, like trees in a thicket. For this reason, when Allah said that the companions of Al-Aykah denied the Messengers, He did not say, "When their brother Shu'ayb said to them." Rather, He said: fix iWhen Shu'ayb said to them} He is not described as belonging to them because of the meaning that was inherent in the name given to them even though he was their brother by blood. Some people did not notice this point, so they thought that the dwellers of Al-Aykah were different from the people of Madyan, and claimed that Shu'ayb was sent to two nations; some said that he was sent to three. 1 >L^} 4The companions of Al-Aykah} were the people of Shu'ayb. This was the view of Ishaq bin Bishr.^ Someone besides Juwaybir said, "The dwellers of Al-Aykah and the people of Madyan are one and the same."*21 And Allah knows best. Although there is another opinion that they were different nations with two identities, the correct view is that they were one nation, but they are described differently in different *** Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :318 At-Jabari 19:390.

places. Shu'ayb preached to them and commanded them to be fair in their weights and measures, the same as is mentioned in

the story of Madyan, which also indicates that they were the same nation. Si pxili- cfil' ^T,uUJu ^181. "Give full measure, and cause no loss (to others)."} "And weigh with the true and straight 4183. "And defraud not people by reducing their things, nor do evil, making corruption and mischief in the land."} 4184. "And have Taqwa of Him Who created you and the generations of the men of old."} The Command to give Full Measure Allah commanded them to give full measure, and forbade them to give short measure. He said: » Si !#3% SP" 4Givefull measure, and cause no loss.} meaning, Swhen you give to people, give them full measure, and do not cause loss to them by giving them short measure, J V.m rvo msesm 'j0S^S: ^ a3]^JiJ^>4>Vjcj»A3i-1i ,dSCoo' ^SjJjV ^ yVr 0 flpJj > /V// ^ / * > » > / . •£ // y»uii . >' >r."A' -> . balance."}

270 TafsTr Ibn Kathir while taking full measure when you are the ones who are taking. Give as you take, and take as you give.' 4And weigh with the true and straight balance. The balance is the scales. 4^X-£ J*Sli \jL±3 4And defraud not people by reducing their things, means, do not shortchange them. u&Vi \ l&O Vj} 4nor do evil, making corruption and mischief in the land.} means, by engaging in banditry. This is like the Ayah, ~jj} 4And sit not on every road, threatening (7:86). pi^ 4And have Taqwa of Him Who created you and the generations of the men of old.} Here he is frightening them with the punishment of Allah Who created them and created their forefathers. This is like when Musa, peace be upon him, said: 4tdji' 'ffQ* viy '&} 4Your Lord and the Lord of your ancient fathers!} (26:26). Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddl, Sufyan bin TJaynah and 'Abdur-Rahm&n bin Zayd bin Aslam said: 41& 4the generations of the men of old.} means, He created the early generations. And Ibn Zayd recited: j-i' &j} 4And indeed he (Shaytdn) did lead astray a great multitude of you} (36:62).' m Af-Tabari 19:392.

4185. They said: "You are only one of those bewitched!"} 4186. "You are but a human being like us and verily, we think that you are one of the liars!"} 4187. "So, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!"} 4188. He said: "My Lord is the Best Knower of what you do."} 4189. But they denied him, so the torment of the Day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud) seized them. Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day.} 4190. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4191 . And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} The Response of Shu'ayb's People, Their Disbelief in Him and the coming of the Punishment upon Them Allah tells us how his people responded, and how it was like the response of Thamud to their Messenger - for they were of like mind - when they said: 4ctf£\$ Si^ 4You are only one of those bewitched!} meaning, "you are one of those who are affected by witchcraft." y£& 4SOH%^3 tj} 4You are but a human being like us and verily, we think that you are one of the liars!} means, "we think you are deliberately lying to us in what you say, and Allah has not sent you to us."

i\$2& Si ^So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us,} Ad-Dahhak said: "One side of the heavens." ' Qatadah said: "A piece of the heaven."*2 As-Suddi said: "A punishment from heaven." This is like what the Quraysh said, as Allah tells us: tjffs .-Xu ' ' <2* <2Si> J } And they say: "We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us} until: \$Or you cause the heaven to fall upon us in pieces, as you have pretended, or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face."} (17:90-92) Si IS Jdgft « £Jl £ iii ££ 4 jLtfl i li'j} iAnd (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this is

indeed the truth from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky..." (8:32). Similarly, these ignorant disbelievers said: *Si ʔʔ Serf** } iSo, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful! } 4He said: "My Lord is the Best Knower of what you do." } means, 'Allah knows best about you, and if you deserve that, He will punish you therewith, and He will not treat you unjustly.' So this is what happened to them - as they asked for - an exact recompense. Allah says: /J- vOe jSi) otic At-Tabari 19:393. ' At-Tabari 22:485.

4&ut they denied him, so the torment of the Day of Shadow seized them. Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day This is what they asked for, when they asked for a part of the heaven to fall upon them. Allah made their punishment in the form of intense heat which overwhelmed them for seven days, and nothing could protect them from it. Then He sent a cloud to shade them, so they ran towards it to seek its shade from the heat. When all of them had gathered underneath it, Allah sent sparks of fire and flames and intense heat upon them, and caused the earth to convulse beneath them, and He sent against them a mighty Sayhah which destroyed their souls. Allah says: 4-^A /j» ty } 4Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day. } Allah has mentioned how they were destroyed in three places in the Qur'an, in each of which it is described in a manner which fits the context. In Surat Al-A'raf He says that the earthquake seized them, and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes. This was because they said: 4 i/ iyCi \$ pj& tLu \p'. jTj 4 "We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb, and those who have believed with you from our town, or else you (all) shall return to our religion." } (7:88). They had sought to scare the Prophet of Allah and those who followed him, so they were seized by the earthquake. In Surah Hud, Allah says: 4And As-Sayhah seized the wrongdoers } (11:94). This was because they mocked the Allah's Prophet when they said: X P\ ijB -4£3 iJ j\ Sjb; C 33 ol I'jb&& } 4 "Does your Saldlt command that we give up what our fathers used to worship, or that we give up doing what we like xoith

our property? Verily, you are the forbearer, right-minded!") (11:87). They had said this in a mocking, sarcastic tone, so it was befitting that the Sayhah should come and silence them, as Allah says: iSo As-Saiha overtook them) (15:73). iAnd As-Saiha seized the wrongdoers) (11:94). And here, they said: *£ 1li SvU&) 4So, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us,) in a stubborn and obstinate manner. So, it was fitting that something they never thought would happen should befall them: It% £&(£ 4,iji p&fr iso the torment of the Day of Shadow seized them. Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day.) Muhammad bin Jarir narrated from Yazid Al-Bahili: "I asked Ibn 'Abbas about this Ayah: ff 4*4 so the torment of the Day of Shadow seized them.) He said: 'Allah sent upon them thunder and intense heat, and it terrified them [so they entered their houses and it pursued them to the innermost parts of their houses and terrified them further], and they ran fleeing from their houses into the fields. Then Allah sent upon them clouds which shaded them from the sun, and they found it cool and pleasant, so they called out to one another until they had all gathered beneath the cloud, then Allah sent fire upon them.' Ibn 'Abbas said, That was the torment of the Day of Shadow, indeed that was the torment of a Great Day.'" m At-Tabari 19:394.

4Verily, in this is an Ayah, yet most of them are not believers. And verily, your Lord, He is truly, the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful. } (26:8-9) meaning, He is All-Mighty in His punishment of the disbelievers, and Most Merciful towards His believing servants. 4192. And truly, this is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists,> 4193. Which the trustworthy Ruh (Jibril) has brought down. } 4194.

Upon your heart that you may be (one) of the warners,} 4195. In the plain Arabic language.} The Qur'an was revealed by Allah Here Allah tells us about the Book which He revealed to His servant and Messenger Muhammad s&. 4And truly, this} refers to the Qur'an, which at the beginning of the Surah was described as £>< s£ Jt^ 4and never comes there unto them a Reminder as a recent revelation from the Most Gracious...} (26:5). 4is a revelation from the Lord of Al-'Alamin.} means, Allah has sent it down to you and revealed it to you. & a 4Which the trustworthy Ruh has brought down.} This refers to Jibril, peace be upon him. This was the view of more than one of the Salaf: Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka*b, Qatadah, 'Atiyyah Al-'Awfi, As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri and Ibn Jurayj. ' This is an issue concerning which there is At-Tabari 19:396.

no dispute. Az-Zuhri said, "This is like the Ayah: 4*3 4' oiU JU£ £ \$} iSay: "Whoever is an enemy to fibril - for indeed he has brought it down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it..."} (2:97). 4>iUi &} iUpon your heart} 'O Muhammad, free from any contamination, with nothing added or taken away.' Si 4that you may be of the warners,} means, 'so that you may warn people with it of the punishment of Allah for those who go against it and disbelieve in it, and so that you may give glad tidings with it to the believers who follow it.' iln the plain Arabic language.} meaning, this Qur'an which We have revealed to you, We have revealed in perfect and eloquent Arabic, so that it may be quite clear, leaving no room for excuses and establishing clear proof, showing the straight path.' 4196. And verily, it is in the Zubur of the former people.} 4197. Is it not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children of Israel knew it?} 4198. And if We had revealed it unto any of the non-Arabs,} 4199. And he had recited it unto them, they would not have believed in it.} The Qur'an was mentioned in the Previous Scriptures Allah says: this Qur'an was mentioned and referred to in the previous Scriptures that were left behind by their Prophets who foretold it in ancient times and more recently. Allah took a covenant from them that they would follow it, and the last of them stood and addressed his people with the good news of

277Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (196 - 199) (Part-19) Ahmad: ir£i*J Q. \$>' \y-j jj Jjii-'i l#~i fv* O'} 4Xr-\ »ii-' Ot at <\$And (remember) when 'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Children of Israel! I am the Messenger of Allah unto you, confirming the Tawrdh before me, and giving glad tidings of a Messenger to come after me, whose name shall be Ahmad. (61:6) Zubur here refers to Books; Zubur is the plural of Az-Zabur, which is also the name used to refer to the Book given to Dawud. Allah says: W }£fa 4And everything they have done is noted in the Az-Zubur.} (54:52), meaning, it is recorded against them in the books of the angels. Then Allah says: \$!££ fZ J% \$& jfr 4Is it not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children of Israel knew it?} meaning, is it not sufficient witness to the truth for them that the scholars of the Children of Israel found this Qur'an mentioned in the Scriptures which they study? The meaning is: the fair-minded among them admitted that the attributes of Muhammad jg and his mission and his Ummah were mentioned in their Books, as was stated by those among them who believed, such as 'Abdullah bin Salam, Salman Al-Farisi and others who met the Prophet jg. Allah said: 4<jH\ <oP& 4Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write ...4 (7:157) The Intense Disbelief of Quraysh Then Allah tells us how intense the disbelief of Quraysh was, and how stubbornly they resisted the Qur'an. If this Book with

278 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ' agom rv-' mmm ^ (t-pS' CA^ ^nLIw.jU_) *J\ • * "/ - "• Jy /// / „ -J^, ^ tsj\$ 0Zj^&"zJ. > 'rf. <}/"/<£** >*C' " (1)U5\ o^IaAji J l* 1> eSglSligu ^ all its eloquence had been revealed to a non-Arab who did not know one word of Arabic, they still would not have believed in him. Allah says: O?" (& ^1/ 1* j*4t^ 'Us 4!^£mss»£ *4 !>^= ^And i/We had revealed it unto any of the non-Arabs, And he had re- cited it unto them, they would not have believed in it.) And Allah says: is ft rf &3 J> & ij& ££tf i&4 z£l (\$[iAnd even if We opened to them a gatefrom the heaven and they were to keep on ascending thereto. They would surely say: "Our eyes have been dazzled..." (15:14-15) i^Cit 'f4l Vij St %} iAnd even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them...} (6: 1 1 1) 4f|py~i3: 't <iCJ oJ^=» jijlc oi>- <is|t 51^ iTruly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe.) (10:96) (M %> & .* &P& v @<U£X 4^ £ulj1 J* (t4<^

\yb l* U iy& V* p-hiU y «'•"<1 » 0»t/—*' 4 lij isji @CuJxi Q 0 Oi gtf EJ 4200. Thus haue We caused it to enter the hearts of the criminals.} They will not believe in it until they see the painful torment.} 4202. It shall come to them of a sudden, while they perceive it not.} 4203. Then they will say: "Can we be respited?"} 4204. Would they then wish for Our torment to be hastened on?} 4205. Think, ifWe do let them enjoyfor years,} 4206. And afterwards comes to them that which they had been promised.} 4207. All that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them.} 4208. And never did We destroy a township but it had its wamers} 4209. By way ofreminder, and We have never been unjust.} The Deniers will never believe until They see the Torment Allah says: 'thus We caused denial, disbelief, rejection and stubbornness to enter the hearts of the sinners.' 4They will not believe in it}, i.e., the truth, 4jyVf w&Si &} 4until they see the painful torment.} means, when their excuses will be of no avail, and the curse will be upon them, and theirs will be an evil abode. 4/f shall come to them of a sudden,} means, the punishment of Allah will come upon them suddenly,

280 Tafclr Ibn Kathlr r*-> iwhile they perceive it not. Then they will say: "Can we be respited?"} means, when they see the punishment, then they will wish they had a little more time so that they can obey Allah - or so they claim. This is like the Ayah: iAnd warn mankind of the Day wlien the torment will come unto them} until: ithat you would not leaved (14:44). When every sinner and evildoer sees his punishment, he will feel intense regret. Such was the case of Fir'awn, when Musa prayed against him: iOur Lord! "You have indeed bestowed on Fir'awn and his chiefs splendor and wealth in the life of this world^ until: j o'jJ ji JB^ i(Allah) said: "Verily, the invocation of you both is accepted."} (10:88-89). This supplication had an effect on Fir'awn: he did not believe until he saw the painful torment: itill when drowning overtook him, he said: "I believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the Children of Israel believe."} until: iand you were one ofthe mischief-makers} (10:90-91). And Allah says: ZL SC \% t&} iso when they saw Our punishment, they said: "We believe in

281Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (200 - 209) (Part-19) Allah Atone..." (40:84-85). uLl) Would they then wish for Our torment to be hastened on?) This is a denunciation and a threat, because they used to say to the Messenger, by way of denial, thinking it unlikely ever to happen: iBring Allah's tormetit upon us) (29:29). This is as Allah said: iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment...) (29:53-55). Then Allah says: s >' > 'A iThink, if VVe do let them enjoy for years, and afterwards comes to them that which they had been promised, all that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them.) meaning, 'even if We

delay the matter and give them respite for a short while or for a long time, then the punishment of Allah comes upon them, what good will their life of luxury do them then?' iThe Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning) (79:46). And Allah says: i J Si , "<> •V 'Itf »> iEveryone of them wishes that he could be given a life of a thousand years. But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from punishment) (2:96). X&Ar*" i<t 'll' >•" *> ,~V iAnd what will his wealth avail him when he goes down?) (92:11)

4<^ 4the people thereof are wrongdoers (28:59). L-j 4m&2 4220. And it is not the Shayatin (devils) who have brought it down.) 4211. Neither would it suit them nor are they able.) 4212. Verily, they have been removed far from hearing it.) The Qur'an was brought down by Jibril, not Shaytan Allah tells us about His Book, which falsehood cannot approach from before or behind it, sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. He states that it has been brought down by the trustworthy Ruh (i.e., Jibril) who is helped by Allah, * fsji Cj) 4And it is not the Shayatin who have brought it down.) Then He tells us that it could not be the case for three reasons that the Shayatin brought it down. One is that it would not suit them, i.e., they have no desire to do so and they do not want to, because their nature is to corrupt and misguide people, but this contains words enjoining what is right and forbidding what is evil, and light, guidance and mighty proofs. There is a big difference between this and the Shayatin, Allah says: ip JP. 4Neither would it suit them) 4&^.%) 4nor are they able.) meaning, even if they wanted to, they could not do it. Allah says: 4% Si £4-^ 14^ & SC^Ii& £0 J) 4Had We sent down this Qur'an on a mountain, you would surely have seen it humbling itself and rent asunder by the fear

you do."} 4227. And put your trust in the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful,} 421S. Who sees you when you stand up.} 4219. And your movements among those who fall prostrate.} 4220. Verily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} The Command to warn His Tribe of near Kindred Here Allah commands (His Prophet jg) to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate, and tells him that whoever associates others in worship with Him, He will punish them. Then Allah commands His Messenger % to warn his tribe of near kindred, i.e., those who were most closely related to him, and to tell them that nothing could save any of them except for faith in Allah. Allah also commanded him to be kind and gentle with the believing servants of Allah who followed him, and to disown those who disobeyed him, no matter who they were. Allah said: . LiyU-xj W* >3ji gj iThen if they disobey you, say : "I am innocent of what you do."} This specific warning does not contradict the general warning; indeed it is a part of it, as Allah says elsewhere: 4£u4>u£ jX) B Cj Ji_jJ^ iln order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, so they are heedless .} (36:6), 4G>^- Irj CfJ-afi 4that you may warn the Mother of the Towns and all around it} (42:7), iAnd warn therewith those who fear that they will be gathered before their Lord} (6:51),

286 Tafslr Ibn Kathir i that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd, and warn with it the most quarrelsome people.} (19:97), i that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach (6:19), and j* -if 'j&> <j*j} i but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place} (11:17). According to Sahlh. Muslim, [the Prophet jg said:] "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, no one from these nations - Jewish or Christian - hears of me then does not believe in me, but he will enter Hell. Many Hadiths have been narrated concerning the revelation of this Ayah, some of which we will quote below: Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may

Allah be pleased with him, said: “When Allah revealed the Ayah, iAnd warn your tribe of near kindred.}, the Prophet jg went to As-Safa’, climbed up and called out, «0 people/» The people gathered around him, some coming of their own accord and others sending people on their behalf to find out what was happening. The Messenger of Allah^ said: gf—i "£»- ji 'iSji ^ 'jii eg! *i m Muslim 1 :134.

287Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ara' (213 - 220) (Part-19) «0 Batti 'Abd Al-Muttalib, O Bani Fihri, O Bani Lu'ayl What do you think, if I told you that there was a cavalry at the foot of this mountain coming to attack you - would you believe me? They said, “Yes.” He said: «77ien I warn you of a great punishment that is close at handJ Abu Lahab said, “May you perish for the rest of the day! You only called us to tell us this?” Then Allah revealed: j\ Tju iPerish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish hel)> [111: 1] [1 This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa’i.[21 Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her said: “When the Ayah: iAnd warn your tribe of near kindred^ was revealed, the Messenger of Allah jg stood up and said: tIAJU! f tcikJl JLp ,w U JLfr o I U tJUjca ol" . ' ' « t-S' • * ^ «0 Fdtimah daughter of Muhammad, O Safiyyah daughter of 'Abd Al-Muttalib, O Bani ‘Abd Al-Muttalib, I cannot help you before Allah. Ask me for whatever you want of my wealth ,»13' This was recorded by Muslim.^' Imam Ahmad recorded that Qabisah bin Mukhariq and Zuhayr bin ‘Amr said: “When the Ayah Ahmad 1:307. Fath Al-Bdri 8 :206 , Muslim 1:193, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :296 , An- Nasa’i in Al-Kubra 6 :526 131 Ahmad 6:187. (4) Muslim 1 :192.

iWho sees you when you stand up.} “When you pray alone.” Ad-Dahhak said: iWho sees you when you stand up.} “When you are lying in bed and when you are sitting.”111 Qatadah said: iWho sees you} “When you are standing, when you are sitting, and in all other situations.”*21 / \ iAnd your movements among those ivho fall prostrate.} Qatadah said: / / / / 4" / •> ' , / , , <W7io sees you w/ien you stand up. And your movements among those who fall prostrate.} “When you pray, He sees you when you pray alone and when you pray in congregation.”131 This was also the view of Ikrimah, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani and Al-Hasan Al-Basri.141 4f& \$ %} iVerily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} He hears all that His servants say and He knows all their movements, as He says: H " ^1 S*- *- Ji Ojlllu ijti dj 4 £j} ' * .i “#5-> oj'-rJ' iNeither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, but I've are Witness thereof, when you are doing it} (10:61). Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:330. ‘Abdur-Razzaq 3 :77 131 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :33 1 At-Tabari 19:413.

pkJi, gx \$ \$ && fl) ^s» <i j S^2»uif jt+*£i »i ^£^0^ it ‘£&j <g%)f& \ju£ \pc Si» 4i l ^tj/(jjxic. AS-j l£* l_yUJ» >Jr-J U AaJ ^222. Shall I inform you upon whom the Shayatin descend?) 4222. They descend on every lying, sinful person (AthTm.) 4223. W/10 giues ear, and most of them are liars.) 4224. As for the poets, the astray follow them,) 4225. See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry?) 4226. And that they say what they do not do.) 4227. Except tlwse who believe and do righteous deeds, and remember Allah much and vindicate themselves after they have been wronged. And tlwse wlw do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned.) Refutation of the Fabrications of the Idolaters Here Allah addresses those idolaters who claimed that what was brought by the Messenger jg was not the truth but was merely something that he had made up by himself, or that it came to him in visions from the Jinn. Allah stated that His Messenger was above their claims and fabrications, and that what he had brought did indeed come from Allah, and that it was a revelation and inspiration, brought down by a noble, trustworthy and mighty angel. It did not come

from the Shayatin, because they have no desire for anything like this Noble Qur'an - they descend upon those who are like them, the lying fortune-tellers. Allah says: 4Shall I inform you) meaning, shall I tell you, 4upon whom the Shayatin descend? They descend on every lying, sinful person (AthTm))

291Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (221 - 227) (Part-19) meaning, one whose speech is lies and fabrication. iAthim} means, whose deeds are immoral. This is the person upon whom the Shayatin descend, fortune-tellers and other sinful liars. The Shayatin are also sinful liars. 4Who gives ear,} means, they try to overhear what is said in the heavens, and they try to hear something of the Unseen, then they add to it a hundred lies and tell it to their human comrades, who then tell it to others. Then the people believe everything they say because they were right about the one thing which was heard from the heavens. This was stated in an authentic Hadith recorded by Al-Bukhari from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, who said, "The people asked the Prophet jg about fortune-tellers, and he said: «T7iei/ are nothing .» They said: "O Messenger of Allah, they say things that come true." The Prophet jg said: ijyiS j oil I <wls3l 8 ijU {jA fsi (j «77irtf is a word of truth which the Jinn snatches, then he gabbles it like the clucking of a chicken into the ear of his friend, but he mixes it with more than one hundred / ies." Al-Bukhari also recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Prophet sg said: .lIUl J, yS\ Jil ^ lip JIS : IjJli J* <LL !jlfa jJLa i jipJL* i jJ>\$\ ja SJjJ 1^3 t 6JuJ ij <« . 4 J 3ji ^ ^ w > 111 Path Al-Bari 13 :545 .

jLJ t_#U Ifcili j>- kuA; -f 'Jl jU ,_,JJ UAS3I <1)1 J-i UUjI Uj t IgldL j I >—>U-JLJ l tSji\ U/j ji ^>- l'.l 1-iS : 1 1-iS 0 Jli jj ; JLL* ^ZjS 5SU UA* ^».aAj i aS^jJu «;ii0i^ ^1 iasJi JiL jlij ?iisj «Whe« Allah decrees a matter in heaven, the angels beat their wings in submission to His decree, a drain beating on a rock. And when the fear in their hearts subsides, they say : "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say: "The truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great." Then when the Jinn who are listening out, one above the others - and Sufyan illustrated this with a gesture, holding his hand vertically with his fingers outspread - mhen they hear this, they throw it down from one to another, until it is passed to the fortune-teller or soothsayer. The shooting star may strike the Jinn before he passes it on, or he may pass it on before he is struck, and he adds to it one hundred lies, thus it is said: "Did he not tell us that on such and such a day, such and such would happen?" So they believe him because of that one thing which was heard from the heavensJ This was recorded by Al-Bukhari. Al-Bukhari recorded from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that the Prophet jg said: ^ — ^UjJl : jliiJl ~ CjjSa jl iZ'jS ZU l\$JU 10jjj^\ US jit U^Jcs IUiSjl "The angels speak in the clouds about some matter on earth, and the Shayatin overhear what they say, so they tell it to the fortune-teller, gurgling into his ear like (a liquid poured)from a glass bottle, and he adds to it one hundred lies .»*2 Refutation ofthe Claim that the Prophet^ was a Poet Path Al-Bari 8 :398 ' Al-Bukhari no. 3288

4Asfor the poets, the astray onesfollow them .} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that this means: "The disbelievers follow the misguided among mankind and the Jinn."11 ' This was also the view of Mujahid, 'Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and others.*2 'Ikrimah said, "Two poets would ridicule one another in verse, with one group of people supporting one and another group supporting the other. Hence Allah revealed the Ayah, 4Asfor the poets, the erring onesfollow them.}*3 fj Sr=® 4 J 4See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry?} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that this means: "They indulge in every kind of nonsense."*4 * Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They engage in every kind of verbal art."*5 ' This was also the view of Mujahid and

others.*6 ' 4And that they say what they do not do.} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that at the time of the Messenger of Allah 5g], two men, one from among the Ansar and one from another tribe, were ridiculing one another in verse, and each one of them was supported by a group of his own people, who were the foolish ones, and Allah said: 4 m 4i4sfor the poets, the erring onesfollow them . See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry? And that they At-Tabari 19:416. At-Tabari 19:415 416. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :323 ' At-Jabari 19:418. *S * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :334 ' At-Tabari 19:417.

294 Tafslr Ibn Kathir say what they do not do.^

What is meant here is that the Messenger jg, to whom this

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4161–4162]

Qur'an was revealed, was not a soothsayer or a poet, because his situation was quite obviously different to theirs, as Allah says: %%2k 6 \$And We have not taught him poetry, nor is it suitable for him. This is only a Reminder and a plain Qur'an .) (36:69), l* Pf Jyj Jy; j* -Pit? jJj-v 4 y5 oj JkA jV, 477wf f/iis is verily, the word of an honored Messenger. It is not the word of a poet, little is that you believe! Nor is it the word of a soothsayer, little is that you remember! This is the Revelation sent doivnfrom the Lord of all that exists.) (69:40-43) The Exception of the Poets of Islam i>Li> P* c/i' 4Except those who believe and do righteous deeds,) Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated from Yazid bin 'Abdullah bin Qusayt, that Abu Al-Hasan Salim Al-Barrad, the freed servant of Tarnim Ad-Dari said: "When the Ayah - 4As for the poets, the erring ones follow them.) was revealed, Hassan bin Thabit, 'Abdullah bin Rawahah and Ka*b bin Malik came to the Messenger of Allah jgg, weeping, and said: "Allah knew when He revealed this Ayah that we are poets. The Prophet £g recited to them the Ayah, ipp i \p: c/j\ y\ i) Except those who believe and do righteous deeds,) and said: iM At-Tabari 19:416.

295 Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ard' (221 - 227) (Part-19) '(This means) you. it {and remember Allah much}. He said: '(This means) you. iand vindicate themselves after they have been wronged.} He said: '(This means) you. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir from the narration of Ibn Ishaq. But this Surah was revealed in Makkah, so how could the

reason for its revelation be the poets of the Ansar? This is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4162–4164]

something worth thinking about. The reports that have been narrated about this are all Mursal and cannot be relied on. And Allah knows best. But this exception could include the poets of the Ansar and others. It even includes those poets of the Ja.hiU.yyah who indulged in condemning Islam and its followers, then repented and turned to Allah, and gave up what they used to do and started to do righteous deeds and remember Allah much, to make up for the bad things that they had previously said, for good deeds wipe out bad deeds. So they praised Islam and its followers in order to make up for their insults, as [the poet] 'Abdullah bin Az-Zab'ari said when he became Muslim: "O Messenger of Allah, indeed my tongue will try to make up for things it said when I was bad - When I went along with the Shaytan during the years of misguidance, and whoever inclines towards his way is in a state of loss."

Similarly, Abu Sufyan bin Al-Harith bin 'Abd Al-Muttalib was one of the most hostile people towards the Prophet ﷺ, even though he was his cousin, and he was the one who used to '1 At-Tabari 19:420. This is not authentic as the author mentions below. There is a narration from Ibn 'Abbas mentioning the exception . It is recorded by Abu Dawud no . 5016.

297 Surah 26. Ash-Shu'ara' (221 - 227) (Part-19) {The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers} (40:52). According to the Sahih, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: faodk jllkjl ijliJlj 'fayf Beware of wrongdoing, for wrongdoing will be darkness on the Day of Resurrection .», Tl Qatadah bin Di'amah said concerning the Ayah - 4JjAa- 1_.A j ^ l_ rUi ^ f/iouse who do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned.} this refers to the poets and others.

Surah 27: An-Naml

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4165–4180]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat An-Naml (Chapter - 27) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ¹ ² ³ ⁴ ⁵ ⁶ ⁷ ⁸ ⁹ ¹⁰ ¹¹ ¹² ¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ ¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ¹⁹ ²⁰ ²¹ ²² ²³ ²⁴ ²⁵ ²⁶ ²⁷ ²⁸ ²⁹ ³⁰ ³¹ ³² ³³ ³⁴ ³⁵ ³⁶ ³⁷ ³⁸ ³⁹ ⁴⁰ ⁴¹ ⁴² ⁴³ ⁴⁴ ⁴⁵ ⁴⁶ ⁴⁷ ⁴⁸ ⁴⁹ ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ ⁵² ⁵³ ⁵⁴ ⁵⁵ ⁵⁶ ⁵⁷ ⁵⁸ ⁵⁹ ⁶⁰ ⁶¹ ⁶² ⁶³ ⁶⁴ ⁶⁵ ⁶⁶ ⁶⁷ ⁶⁸ ⁶⁹ ⁷⁰ ⁷¹ ⁷² ⁷³ ⁷⁴ ⁷⁵ ⁷⁶ ⁷⁷ ⁷⁸ ⁷⁹ ⁸⁰ ⁸¹ ⁸² ⁸³ ⁸⁴ ⁸⁵ ⁸⁶ ⁸⁷ ⁸⁸ ⁸⁹ ⁹⁰ ⁹¹ ⁹² ⁹³ ⁹⁴ ⁹⁵ ⁹⁶ ⁹⁷ ⁹⁸ ⁹⁹ ¹⁰⁰ ¹⁰¹ ¹⁰² ¹⁰³ ¹⁰⁴ ¹⁰⁵ ¹⁰⁶ ¹⁰⁷ ¹⁰⁸ ¹⁰⁹ ¹¹⁰ ¹¹¹ ¹¹² ¹¹³ ¹¹⁴ ¹¹⁵ ¹¹⁶ ¹¹⁷ ¹¹⁸ ¹¹⁹ ¹²⁰ ¹²¹ ¹²² ¹²³ ¹²⁴ ¹²⁵ ¹²⁶ ¹²⁷ ¹²⁸ ¹²⁹ ¹³⁰ ¹³¹ ¹³² ¹³³ ¹³⁴ ¹³⁵ ¹³⁶ ¹³⁷ ¹³⁸ ¹³⁹ ¹⁴⁰ ¹⁴¹ ¹⁴² ¹⁴³ ¹⁴⁴ ¹⁴⁵ ¹⁴⁶ ¹⁴⁷ ¹⁴⁸ ¹⁴⁹ ¹⁵⁰ ¹⁵¹ ¹⁵² ¹⁵³ ¹⁵⁴ ¹⁵⁵ ¹⁵⁶ ¹⁵⁷ ¹⁵⁸ ¹⁵⁹ ¹⁶⁰ ¹⁶¹ ¹⁶² ¹⁶³ ¹⁶⁴ ¹⁶⁵ ¹⁶⁶ ¹⁶⁷ ¹⁶⁸ ¹⁶⁹ ¹⁷⁰ ¹⁷¹ ¹⁷² ¹⁷³ ¹⁷⁴ ¹⁷⁵ ¹⁷⁶ ¹⁷⁷ ¹⁷⁸ ¹⁷⁹ ¹⁸⁰ ¹⁸¹ ¹⁸² ¹⁸³ ¹⁸⁴ ¹⁸⁵ ¹⁸⁶ ¹⁸⁷ ¹⁸⁸ ¹⁸⁹ ¹⁹⁰ ¹⁹¹ ¹⁹² ¹⁹³ ¹⁹⁴ ¹⁹⁵ ¹⁹⁶ ¹⁹⁷ ¹⁹⁸ ¹⁹⁹ ²⁰⁰ ²⁰¹ ²⁰² ²⁰³ ²⁰⁴ ²⁰⁵ ²⁰⁶ ²⁰⁷ ²⁰⁸ ²⁰⁹ ²¹⁰ ²¹¹ ²¹² ²¹³ ²¹⁴ ²¹⁵ ²¹⁶ ²¹⁷ ²¹⁸ ²¹⁹ ²²⁰ ²²¹ ²²² ²²³ ²²⁴ ²²⁵ ²²⁶ ²²⁷ ²²⁸ ²²⁹ ²³⁰ ²³¹ ²³² ²³³ ²³⁴ ²³⁵ ²³⁶ ²³⁷ ²³⁸ ²³⁹ ²⁴⁰ ²⁴¹ ²⁴² 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from One Who is Wise in His commands and prohibitions, and Who knows all things, major and minor. Whatever He says is absolute Truth, and His rulings are entirely fair and just, as Allah says:

S iliaijfa- tva V, Uj^ i*Lj c~J£ 7 Ljjj ^--aii 1 fv.j'.j.,\) 1^ . Pt - '.<>." •> •>';>- S^0^v3iS!CiiiiSi^oj%1; \$ 'o^>»1£»cA^~i UlfiJ 4Awd the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). cliC i4»V jfi l^i'» J -jyr £* iiji- j>£ .y,PjfLU, >JJ jj y£» . . * -> ,5^ JI j4 -^y o* <-\$*? «*u- Ui • *" if "/ >/ .ijf VL> 4tt» (>>w^J t>*J .jUJl 'it ct 4 :£*£>“ a & :S^t #» £ ££ dj%&% lil« * 4l^ -3«£ vl? 3 ii» * *3) '©SjL^it 23 *>? t,r '*j' . * '{•' yy* W %y* -*“*? J-V <^ft 4 j?4S l!4'» (*r*t)- Cto pfdsiJi Vfi \j6 t±ijj ojp jl yjt, gli j jyi> ji. JLi- j£" J-tili ijlcj LJLt j^lii'l 4:U-»-b ^ 'j-^iS 'i^ . ?wJ UC* ipli 'CPf> itjtsUiJfi& 47. (Remember) when Musa said to his household: "Verily, I have seen a fire; I will bring you from there some information, or I will bring you a burning ember, that you may warm yourselves."} 48. But when he came to it, he was called: "Blessed is whosoever is in the fire, and whosoever is round about it! And glorified be Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} 49. "O Musa! Verily, it is I, Allah, the All-Mighty, the All-Wise."}

303 Surah 27. An-Naml (7 - 14) (Part-19) 410. ",And throw down your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and did not look back. (It was said:) "O Musa! Fear not: verily, the Messengers fear not in front of Me."} ill. "Except him who has done wrong and afterwards has changed evil for good; then surely, I am Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} 412. "And put your hand into opening of your garment, it will come forth white without hurt. (These are) among the nine signs (you will take) to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious."} 413. But when Our Ayat came to them, clear to see, they said: "This is a manifest magic."} 414. And they belied them wrongfully and arrogantly, though they themselves were convinced thereof. So, see what was the end of the mischief-makers.} The Story of Musa and the End of Fir'awn Here Allah tells His Messenger Muhammad 3gl about what happened to Musa, peace be upon him, how Allah chose him, spoke with him and gave him mighty, dazzling signs and overwhelming proof, and sent him to Fir'awn and his people, but they denied the proof, disbelieved in him and arrogantly refused to follow him. Allah says: 4*4) 3® -> 1^ 4 when Musa said to his household}, meaning, remember when Musa was traveling with his family and lost his way. This was at night, in the dark. Musa had seen a fire beside the mountain, i.e., he had noticed a fire burning brightly, and said, 4^i \$ c-j 4 to his household: "Verily, I have seen a fire; I will bring you from there some information..."} meaning, 'about the way we should take.' 4<z>j^ Jffi yifi* f^y

ior I will bring you a burning ember, that you may warm yourselves.) meaning, so that they could keep warm. And it was as he said: "He came back with great news, and a great light." Allah says: <yj 4 or 4a* ^ £&) <\$ But when he came to it, he was called: "Blessed is whosoever is in the fire, and whosoever is round about it!")' meaning, when he came to it, he saw a great and terrifying sight: the fire was burning in a green bush, and the fire was burning ever brighter while the bush was growing ever more green and beautiful. Then he raised his head, and saw that its light was connected to the clouds of the sky. Ibn 'Abbas and others said, "It was not a fire, rather it was shining light." According to one report narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, it was the Light of the Lord of the worlds.' ! Musa stood amazed by what he was seeing, and 4 or J ihe was called: "Blessed is whosoever is in the fire..." Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means. Holy is (whosoever is in the fire).!" 2' iand whosoever is round about it) means, of the angels.

This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Sa'd bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan and Qatadah.'3 ' 4And glorified be Allah, the Lord of all that exists), Who does whatever He wills and there is nothing like Him among His creation. Nothing He has made can encompass Him, and He is the Exalted, the Almighty, Who is utterly At-Tabari 19:428. Af-Tabari 19:428. ' At-Tabari 19:429, Al-Muharrar Al-Wajiz 4 :250, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur

unlike all that He has created. Heaven and earth cannot contain Him, but He is the One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who is far above any comparison with His creation. fork) iO Musa! Verily, it is I, Allah, the All-Mighty, the All- Wise.} Allah told him that the One Who was addressing him was his Lord Allah, the All-Mighty, Who has subjugated and subdued all things, the One Who is Wise in all His words and deeds. Then He commanded him to throw down the stick that was in his hand, so that He might show him clear proof that He is the One Who is able to do all things, whatever He wills. When Musa threw that stick down, it changed into the form of a huge and terrifying snake, moving quickly despite its size. Allah says: i%\$\$ (1} iBut when he saw it moving as if it were a Jann (snake).} Jann refers to a type of snake that is the fastest-moving and most agile. When Musa saw that with his own eyes, ihe turned in flight, and did not look back.} meaning, he did not turn around, because he was so afraid. Allah's saying: \ S3 SZ &£.} iO Musa! Fear not : verily, the Messengers fear not in front of Me.} means, 'do not be afraid of what you see, for I want to choose you as a Messenger and make you a great Prophet.' * -a4 4Except him who has done wrong and afterwards has changed evil for good; then surely, I am Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is an exception of the exclusionary type. This is good news for mankind, for whoever does an evil deed then gives it

up and repents and turns to Allah, Allah will accept his repentance, as He says: MV j^J <^>1: Jlj jU3 j|£} 4And verily, Iam indeedforgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous good deeds, and then AhtadaP] } (20:82) 4P~ 4And whoever does evil or wrongs himself. . .> (4: 1 10). And there are many other Ayat which say the same. tr o* ~ }£* 4 -ift &\$>} 4And put your hand into the opening ofyour garment, it will come forth white without hurt.} This is another sign, further brilliant proof of the ability of Allah to do whatever He wills. It is also confirmation of the truth of the one to whom the miracle was given. Allah commanded him to put his hand into the opening of his garment, and when he put his hand in and took it out again, it came out white and shining as if it were a piece of the moon or a flash of dazzling lightning. gfi <f} 4among the nine signs} means, 'these are two of the nine signs which you will be supported with and which will serve as proof for you.' 4to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious.} These were the nine signs of which Allah said: £\$ yi& Gfr JSSj} 4And indeed We gave Musa nine clear signs} (17:101) - as we have stated thereJ2 4Z£ esc &} 111 Meaning, he is guided. See the Tafsir of Surah TaHa (20 :82) I2 ' See volume nine, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Isra (17:101)

{But when Our Aydt came to them, clear to see,}, i.e., clear and obvious, * { "A- ui ithey said: "This is a manifest magic" .} They wanted to oppose it with their own magic, but they were defeated and were returned disgraced. 4^1 V^f} iAnd they belied them means, verbally, ithough they themselves were convinced thereof.} means, they knew deep down that this was truth from Allah, but they denied it and were stubborn and arrogant. iwrongfully and arrogantly} means, wronging themselves because this was the despicable manner to which they were accustomed, and they were arrogant because they were too

proud to follow the truth. Allah said: {So, see what was the end of the mischief-makers.} meaning, 'see, O Muhammad, what were the consequences of their actions when Allah destroyed them and drowned every last one of them in a single morning.' The point of this story is: beware, 'O you who disbelieve in Muhammad and deny the Message that he has brought from his Lord, lest the same thing that befell them befall you also.' But what is worse, is that Muhammad is nobler and greater than Musa, and his proof is stronger than that of Musa, for the signs that Allah has given him are combined with his presence and his character, in addition to the fact that previous Prophets foretold his coming and took a covenant from the people that they would follow him if they should see him, may the best of blessings and peace from his Lord be upon him. oCc If jff Jp liLi ttll 4\ AlX' "jlij dip julLij llcl. £&j}

308 Tafstr Ibn Kathir l jU q? j.u Ql jig *)' 0 «:.*» H& % J&j 0aft »>>' .^1 •; tU* & ^1~L. * - ' 4*^* i'j & !?' : i Jti) l+b* j* > Cm A *•+ 4—Joy \$& & do % ZZ& 415. And indeed We gave knowledge to Dawud and Sulaymndn, and they both said: "All praise be to Allah, Who has preferred us above many of His believing servants!"} 416. And Sulayman inherited from Dawud. He said: "O mankind! We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything. This, verily, is an evident grace."} 417. And there were gathered before Sulayman his hosts of Jinn and men, and birds, and they all were set in battle order (marching forward).} 418. Till, when they came to the valley of the ants, one of the ants said "O ants! Enter your dwellings, lest Sulayman and his armies should crush you, while they perceive not."} 419. So he (Sulayman) smiled, amused at her speech and said: "My Lord! Grant me the power and ability that I may be grateful for Your favors which You have bestowed on me and on my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds that will please You, and admit me by Your mercy among Your righteous servants."} Dawud and Sulayman (peace be upon them), the organization of Sulayman's Troops and His passage through the Valley of the Ants Here Allah tells us about the great blessings and favors which He bestowed upon two of His servants and Prophets, Dawud (David) and his son Sulayman (Solomon), peace be upon them both, and how they enjoyed happiness in this world and the Hereafter, power and authority in this world, and the position of being Prophets and Messengers. Allah says:

•fe £ uli tfjf m. Jui> 'jiiij iLL ijij uC indeed We gave knowledge to Dawud and Sulaymndn, and they both said: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has preferred us above many of His believing servants!") 4And Sulaymndn inherited from Dawud.) means, in kingship and prophethood. What is meant here is not wealth, because if that were the case, Sulayman would not have been singled out from among the sons of Dawud, as Dawud had one hundred wives. Rather what is meant is the inheritance of kingship and prophethood, for the wealth of the Prophets cannot be inherited, as the Messenger of Allah ggjj said: oiisj> u ».dVi viUJ "I've Prophets cannot be inherited from; whatever we leave behind is charity And Sulayman said: \$ & djjJM jki dipJM£&) 40 mankind! We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything.) Here Sulayman was speaking of the blessings that Allah bestowed upon him, by giving him complete authority and power, whereby mankind, the Jinn and the birds were subjugated to him. He also knew the language of the birds and animals, which is something that had never been given to any other human being - as far as we know from what Allah and His Messenger told us. Allah enabled Sulayman to understand what the birds said to one another as they flew through the air, and what the different kinds of animals said. Sulayman said: Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:234. Similar was recorded by Al-Bukhari no.

4We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything. i.e., all things that a king needs. &&\$ % iThis, verily, is an evident grace.) means, this is clearly the blessings of Allah upon us.' (*4 iAnd there were gathered before Sulayman his hosts of Jinn and men, and birds, and they all were set in battle order.) means, all of Sulayman's troops of Jinn, men and birds were gathered together, and he rode with them in a display of might and glory, with people marching behind him, followed by the Jinn, and the birds flying above his head. When it was hot, they would shade him with their wings. ft*? iand they all were set in battle order.) The first and the last of them were brought together, so that none of them would step out of place. Mujahid said: "Officials were appointed to keep each group in order, and to keep the first and the last together so that no one would step out of line - just as kings do nowadays. 11 ' iplf h \$h iTill, when they came to the valley of the ants,) meaning, when Sulayman, the soldiers and the army with him crossed the valley of the ants, i/ w*/ >>>' ' | 'fs* |V*i V'5 .ii iOne of the ants said: "O ants! Enter your dwellings, lest Sulayman and his armies should crush you, while they perceive not."} Sulayman, peace be upon him, understood what the ant said, 111 At-Tabari 19 :500, 501

\$&& iSo he smiled, amused at her speech and said: "My Lord! Grant me the power and ability that I may be grateful for Your favors which You have bestowed on me and on my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds that will please You,) meaning: "inspire me to give thanks for the blessings that You have bestowed upon me by teaching me to understand what the birds and animals say, and the blessings that You have bestowed upon my parents by making them Muslims who believe in You.' L\$ iand that / may do righteous good deeds that will please You,) means, 'deeds that You love which will earn Your pleasure.' 4and admit me by Your mercy among Your righteous servants.) means, "when You cause me to die, then join me with the righteous among Your servants, and the Higher Companion among Your close friends.' 420. He inspected the birds, and said: "What is the matter that I see not the hoopoe? Or is he among the absentees?") 421. "I will surely punish him with a severe torment or slaughter him, unless he brings me a clear reason.") The Absence of the Hoopoe Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and others narrated from Ibn 'Abbas and others that the hoopoe was an expert who used to show Sulayman where water was if he was out in open land and needed water. The hoopoe would look for water for him in the various strata of the earth, just as a man looks at things on the surface of the earth, and he would know just how far below the surface the water was. When the hoopoe showed

him where the water was, Sulayman would command the Jinn to dig in that place until they brought water from the depths of the earth. One day Sulayman went to some open land and checked on the birds, but he could not see the hoopoe. ifji 'i iand (Sulayman) said: "What is the matter that I see not the hoopoe? Or is he among the absentees?") One day 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas told a similar story, and among the people was a man from the Khaw&rij whose name was Nafi' bin Al-Azraq, who often used to raise objections to Ibn 'Abbas. He said to him, "Stop, O Ibn 'Abbas; you will be defeated (in argument) today!" Ibn 'Abbas said: "Why?" Nafi' said: "You are telling us that the hoopoe can see water beneath the ground, but any boy can put seed in a trap and cover the trap with dirt, and the hoopoe will come and take the seed, so the boy can catch him in the trap." Ibn 'Abbas said, "If it was not for the fact that this man would go and tell others that he had defeated Ibn 'Abbas in argument, I would not even answer." Then he said to Nafi': "Woe to you! When the decree strikes a person, his eyes become blind and he loses all caution." Nafi' said: "By Allah I will never dispute with you concerning

anything in the Qur'an." 41 will surely punish him with a severe torment Al-A'mash said, narrating from Al-Minhal bin 'Amr from Said that Ibn 'Abbas said: "He meant, by plucking his feathers." 2 I 'Abdullah bin Shaddad said: "By plucking his feathers and exposing him to the sun." 31 This was also the view of more than one of the Salaf, that it means plucking his feathers and leaving him exposed to be eaten by ants. 4S&.sfi 4or slaughter him,} means, killing him. Al-Qurtubi 13:177 178. At-Tabari 19:443. At-Tabari 19:443.

323 Surah 27. An-Naml (22 - 26) (Part-19 J mm (+4^==*-p**> _>LJic-ij'jC- VIf|p •oil O^LLoUj j S^SS&C fyJi#K -. [ills \$S/bbC ^ 4)jt S^l ijli^UbjiLsI unless he brings me a clear reason. The hoopoe said, "Then I am saved." 4.^? 4^3 \$¥ 4unless he brings me a clear reason.} i.e., a valid excuse. Sufyan bin 'Uyaynah and 'Abdullah bin Shaddad said: "When the hoopoe came back, the other birds said to him: "What kept you? Sulayman has vowed to shed your blood." The hoopoe said: "Did he make any exception [did he say "unless"]?" They said, "Yes, he said: jt \1^ li& 41 will surely punish him with a severe torment or slaughter him, 41 ps p* <x •* -W p P. Jtii jJuJi ji, U-*jb Wi-uy vi? '-4i ji1 ji c£»l> ipl ojI4 V (* 4^' f jH-1 oii> *1' j>j (>• ^-llu Ly ojt*- U %uj Jfjiiij v>y^ll 4 ifjl j5j Ltii-i VI S^jpiyjLJj c^-*" 4u _>* V't V *il 422 . But (the hoopoe) stayed not long, he said: "I have grasped which you have not grasped and I have come to you from Saba' with true news."} 423. "Ifound a woman ruling over them, she has been given

324 Tafslr Ibn Kathir all things, and she has a great throne."} 424. "Ifound her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them to prevent them from the way, so they have no guidance."} 425. So they do not prostrate themselves before fillah, Who brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth, and knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} 426. Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!"}

How the Hoopoe came before Sulayman and told Him

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4180–4189]

about Saba Allah says: 4^fi jf. l^Jt} 4But (the hoopoe) stayed not long,} meaning, he was absent for only a short time. Then he came and said to Sulayman: 4' 41 have grasped which you have not grasped} meaning, I have come to know something that you and your troops do not know.' 4.\$?. pj pr" 4and I have come to you from Saba' with true news.} meaning, with true and certain news. Saba' (Sheba) refers to Himyar, they were a dynasty in Yemen. Then the hoopoe said: 4ih^=»K ' *£' o[} 4Ifound a woman ruling over them,} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "This is Bilqis bint Sharahl, the queen of Saba'." Allah's saying: 4she has been given all things,} means, all the conveniences of Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :351

this world that a powerful monarch could need. iand she has a great throne.} meaning, a tremendous chair adorned with gold and different kinds of jewels and pearls. The historians said, "This throne was in a great, strong palace which was high and firmly constructed. In it there were three hundred and sixty windows on the east side, and a similar number on the west, and it was constructed in such a way that each day when the sun rose it would shine through one window, and when it set it would shine through the opposite window. And the people used to prostrate to the sun morning and evening. This is why the

hoopoe said: - ' >>' 41 found her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has prevented them from the way,} meaning, from the way of truth. so they have no guidance.} Allah's saying: V* V if L?JJT iand Shaytdn has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has prevented them from the way, so they have no guidance, so they do not prostrate themselves before Allah.} They do not know the way of truth, prostrating only before Allah alone and not before anything that He has created, whether heavenly bodies or anything else. This is like the Ayah: H plij jLLlfj X&J £#^} 4And from among His signs are the night and the day, and the sun and the moon. Prostrate yourselves not to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, if you indeed worship Him.} (41:37)

idSb&& a & 4'^ iWho brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said: "He knows everything that is hidden in the heavens and on earth."111 This was also the view of 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and others.121 His saying: Cj ofoi £ iand knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} means, He knows what His servants say and do in secret, and what they say and do openly. This is like the Ayah J* 1>*J 'it j-ft- i)*J 4 ,y ^} 4It is the same whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day} (13:10). His saying: ti^ •*, V ^} 4Allah, La ildha ilia Huwa, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} means, He is the One to be called upon, Allah, He is the One other than Whom there is no god, the Lord of the Supreme Throne, and there is none greater than Him in all of creation. Since the hoopoe was calling to what is good, and for people to worship and prostrate to Allah alone, it would have been forbidden to kill him. Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet %% forbade killing four kinds of animals: ants, bees, hoopoes and the sparrow hawks. Its chain of narration is Sthih.131 Ad-DurrAOManthur6:352. At-Tabari 19:445, 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :81 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:352 131 Ahmad 1:332, Abu Dawud 5:418, Ibn Majah 2:1074, also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas.

ty P 'Ji \$^jS3t Sj SX ft 3SZi ££ js Cr*-j~* <>J v^T dj ij\$ ti[It-fe >i)U bt* Jls6 / ^32s,x _ 4 >{, /<> » >•* ij ^ ,x' ^ 'y _ . 427 . (Sulayman) said: "We shall see whether you speak the truth or you are (one) of the liars."4 428. "Go you with this letter of mine and deliver it to them, then draw back from them and see what they return."4 429. She said: "O chiefs! Verily, here is delivered to me a noble letter,"4 430. "Verily , it is from Sulayman, and it (reads): 'In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful;'4 431 . 'Be you not exalted against me, but come to me submitting (as Muslims).' "4 Sulayman's Letter to Bilqis Allah tells us what Sulayman said to the hoopoe when he told him about the people of Saba' and their queen: Oj ft oSju3 jJliuS. jtt*> 4(Sulayman) said: "We shall see whether you speak the truth or you are (one) of the liars."4 meaning, 'are you telling the truth? iUgSi U ft» 4or you are (one) of the liars. meaning, 'or are you telling a lie in order to save yourself from the threat I made against you?' 4 b£ JliiS ffJ- 3j5 lili 4Go you with this letter of mine and deliver it to them then draw back from them and see what they return. Sulayman wrote a letter to Bilqis and her people and gave it to the hoopoe to deliver. It was said that he carried it on his wings, as is the way with birds, or that he carried it in his beak. He went to their land and found the palace of Bilqis, then he went to her private chambers and threw the letter through a small window, then he stepped to one side out of

&\$&W &-&^ C 6,^ ijO #£. c«» »ii ijfca & jse <sc^ ^^ ^ j* %!&fa r#%£\$ 4\$^ tful &t t?£S 1*4^1 <32. S/ie said: "O chichi/ Advise me in case of mine. I decide no case till you are present with me."} 433 . They said : "We have great strength, and great ability for war, but it is for you to command; so think over what you will command."} 434. She said: "Verily, kings, when they enter a town, they destroy it and make the most honorable among its people the lowest. And thus they do."} 435. "But verily, I am going to send him a present, and see with what (answer) the messengers return."} Bilqis consults with Her Chiefs When she read Sulayman's letter to them and consulted with them about this news, she said: 4jU-V-i <!#*"£ £ sfo 4 djr*\ ijili' 4"0 chiefs! Advise me in (this) case of mine. I decide no case till you are present with me."} meaning, "until you come together and offer me your advice.' •(They said: "We have great strength, and great ability for war..."} They reminded her of their great numbers, preparedness and strength, then they referred the matter to her and said: ibut it is for you to command; so think over what you will command.} meaning, "we have the power and strength, if you want to go to him and fight him.' The matter is yours to decide, so instruct us as you see fit and we will obey. Ibn 'Abbas said:

322Surah 27. An-Naml (36 - 37) (Part-19 Prophet, so follow him." jiA 21> *£»- ii? Hi JLiJ CpjjJ Jtt ;Il Cji^ (4H^J ^ jii <£* y A&i (if?i jrj' 436. So, when (the messengers with the gift) came to Sulayman, he said: "Will you help me in wealth? What Allah has given me is better than that which He has given you! Nay, you rejoice in your gift!"} 437. "Go back to them. We verily, shall come to them with armies that they cannot resist, and we shall drive them out from there in disgrace, and they will be abased."} The Gift and the Response ofSulayman More than one of the scholars of Tafsir among the Salaf and others stated that she sent him a huge gift of gold, jewels, pearls and other things. It is apparent that Sulayman, peace be upon him, did not even look at what they brought at all and did not pay any attention to it, but he turned away and said, rebuking them: i"Will you help me in wealth?"} meaning, 'are you trying to flatter me with wealth so that I will leave you alone with your Shirk and your kingdom?' ~lii jO- Hi^ iWhat Allah has given me is better than that which He has given you!} means, *what Allah has given to me of power, wealth and troops, is better than that which you have.' 4j^ii ^4,; jiA Ji} }Nay, you rejoice in your gift!} means, tyou are the ones who are influenced by gifts and presents; we will accept nothing from you except Islam or the sword.' m At-Tabari 19 :455

}Go back to them^ means, with their gift, & * j&e gp 4We verily, shall come to them with armies that they cannot resist, they have no power to match them or resist them. Vi iand we shall drive them outfrom there in disgrace,} *we shall drive them out in disgrace from their land.' iand they will be abased means, humiliated and expelled. When her messengers came back to her with her undelivered gift, and told her what Sulayman said, she and her people paid heed and obeyed him. She came to him with her troops in submission and humility, honoring Sulayman and intending to follow him in Islam. When Sulayman, peace be upon him, realized that they were coming to him, he rejoiced greatly. 138. He said: "O chiefs! Which ofyou can bring me her throne before they come to me surrendering themselves in obedience (as Muslims)?"} 139. An 'Ifritfrom the Jinn said: "I will bring it to you before you rise from your place. And verily, 1 am indeed strong and trustworthyfor such work."} 140. One with whom was knowledge of the Scripture, said : "I will bring it to you within the twinkling ofan eye!" Then when he saw it placed before him, he said: "This is by the grace of my Lord - to test me whether I

am grateful or ungrateful! And whoever is grateful, truly, his gratitude is for himself; and whoever is ungrateful, certainly my Lord is Rich, Bountiful.”}

How the Throne of Bilqis was brought in an Instant

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4189–4195]

Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Yazid bin Ruman: “When the messengers returned with word of what Sulayman said, she said: *By Allah, I knew he was more than a king, and that we have no power to match him, and that we can gain nothing by being stubborn with him. So, she sent word to him saying: “I am coming to you with the leaders of my people to see what you will instruct us to do and what you are calling us to of your religion.” Then she issued commands that her throne, which was made of gold and inlaid with rubies, chrysolite and pearls, should be placed in the innermost of seven rooms, one within the other, and all the doors should be locked. Then she told her deputy whom she was leaving in charge, “Take care of my people and my throne, and do not let anyone approach it or see it until I come back to you.” Then she set off to meet Sulayman with twelve thousand of her commanders from the leaders of Yemen, under each of whose command were many thousands of men. Sulayman sent the Jinn to bring him news of her progress and route every day and night, then when she drew near, he gathered together the Jinns and humans who were under his control and said: s\$ j j3 IK? ^p i&it 40 chiefs! Which of you can bring me her throne before they come to me surrendering themselves in obedience (as Muslims)?}.”¹¹ 4An ‘Ifntfrom the jinn said :} Mujahid said, “A giant Jinn.” Abu Salih said, “It was as if he was a mountain. ”*2 4/ will bring it to you before you rise from your place.} Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “Before you get up from where you are sitting.”*3 At-Tabari 9:520. ’ Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :359 131 Al-Baghawi 3:420.

As-Suddi and others said: “He used to sit to pass judgements and rulings over the people, and to eat, from the beginning of the day until noon.” ilS)&&\$} iAnd verily, I am indeed strong and trustworthy for such work.} Ibn ‘Abbas said: “Strong enough to carry it and trustworthy with the jewels it contains. Sulayman, upon him be peace, said, “I want it faster than that.”¹¹ From this it seems that Sulayman wanted to bring this throne as a demonstration of the greatness of the power and authority that Allah had bestowed upon him and the troops that He had subjugated to him. Power such as had never been given to anyone else, before or since, so that this would furnish proof of his prophethood before Bilqis and her people, because this would be a great and wondrous thing, if he brought her throne as if he were in her country, before they could come to it, although it was hidden and protected by so many locked doors. When Sulayman said, “I want it faster than that, iJ£f £% fe ji\$ iOne with whom was knowledge of the Scripture said:} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This was Asif, the scribe of Sulayman.” It was also narrated by Muhammad bin Ishaq from Yazid bin Ruman that he was Asif bin Barkhiya' and he was a truthful believer who knew the Greatest Name of Allah . Qatadah said: “He was a believer among the humans, and his name was Asif.” iui% <J 35 *4, Ax il will bring it to you within the twinkling of an eye!} Meaning, lift your gaze and look as far as you can, and before you get tired and blink, you will find it before you. Then he got up, performed ablution and prayed to Allah, may He be exalted. Mujahid said: “He said, O Owner of majesty and honor.”*3 *** Al-Baghawi 3 :420. * Al-Baghawi 3 :420 [3] At-Tabari 19:466.

325 Surah 27, An-Naml (38 - 40) (Part-19) When Sulayman and his chiefs saw it before them, he said: "This is by the grace of my Lord..." meaning, 'this is one of the blessings which Allah has bestowed upon me.' 4P& j&. r' -spy 4to test whether I am grateful or ungrateful! And whoever is grateful, truly, his gratitude is for himself;} This is like the Ayat £.1 £5P& P*} iWhosoever does righteous good deed, it is for himself; and whosoever does evil, it is against himself.} (41:46) iand whosoever does righteous good deed, then such will prepare a good place for themselves.} (30:44). iand whoever is ungrateful, certainly my Lord is Rich, Bountiful.} He has no need of His servants or their worship. 4%y=y iBountiful} He is Bountiful in and of Himself, even if no one were to worship Him. His greatness does not depend on anyone. This is like what MQsa said: imLir&& J# jPf o\} ilf you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich, Owner of all praise.} (14:8). It is recorded in Sahih Muslim: PPyUj 'ppsypj jJSjf \$ &£* G :juc Jj> ypj of \$&irf u . pi j, Ju> so u jjs p: JS c &>J& ji iUi>£ U -p.pjp p \JSpro 'ppo

326 Tafisir Ibn Kathir Cj** UJJ ^jII J<—^ ^! dr*^ >iiJi 'f* x>-j j£j «. <bl <iAllah, may He be exalted, says: "O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, mankind and Jinn alike, were all to be as pious as the most pious among you, that would not add to My dominion in the slightest. O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, mankind and Jinn alike, were all to be as evil as the most evil one among you, that would not detract from My dominion in the slightest. O My servants, these are deeds which I am recording for you, and I will judge you according to them, so whomever finds something good, let him praise Allah, and whoever finds otherwise, let him blame no one but himself."»m Ufcj Ji a .vfoi^r V v OjSo 'A XSJ& Ja l£> U l££ JSy ji' £ UJLy Ji %fi /OK^ cJU idijp ^ 4W u Si £ « ZX Qi - ' •, *?S\> " **\Ar :r >n. t. - ' vvt> **i O- * . £ ki—I— —ij 4^c<ubJ' He said: "Disguise her throne for her that we may see whether she will be guided, or she will be one of those not guided."} 442. So when she came, it was said, "Is your throne like this?" She said: "As though it were the very same." And he said, "Knowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah (as Muslims)."} 443. And Saddaha that which she used to worship besides Allah has prevented her (from Islam), for she was of a disbelieving people.} 444. It was said to her: "Enter As-Sarh," but when she saw it, she thought it was a pool, and she (tucked up her clothes) uncovering her legs. Sulayman said: "Verily, it is a Sarh Mumarrad of Qawatr." She said: "My Lord! Verily, I have Muslim 4 :1994.

wronged myself, and I submit, together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} The Test of Bilqis When Sulayman brought the throne of Bilqis before she and her people arrived, he issued orders that some of its features should be altered, so that he could test her and see whether she recognized it and how composed she would be when she saw it. Would she hasten to say either that it was her throne or that it was not? So he said: v juK oj 4^ s' (1 i iDisguise her throne for her that we may see whether she will be guided, or she will be one of those not guided.} Ibn 'Abbas said: "Remove some of its adornments and parts." * Mujahid said: "He issued orders that it should be changed, so whatever was red should be made yellow and vice versa, and whatever was green should be made red, so everything was altered." 'Ikrimah said, "They added some things and took some things away." Qatadah said, "It was turned upside down and back to front, and some things were added and some things were taken away."*2 jj o't &} iSo when she came, it was said: "Is your throne like this?"} Her throne, which had been altered and disguised, with some things added and others taken away, was shown to her. She was wise and steadfast, intelligent and strong-willed. She did not hasten to say that

this was her throne, because it was far away from her. Neither did she hasten to say that it was not her throne, when she saw that some things had been altered and changed. She said. (It is) as though it were the very same.) This is the ultimate in intelligence and strong resolve. At-Tabari 19:469. At-Tabari 19:469.

oi _»U' iKnowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah.) Mujahid said, "This was spoken by Sulayman."* 11 /j* jl' <>; 4And Saddaha that which she used to worship besides Allah has prevented her, for she was of a disbelieving people.) This is a continuation of the words of Sulayman — according to the opinion of Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr, may Allah be pleased with them both - i.e., Sulayman said: y. iKnowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah .) and what stopped her from worshipping Allah alone was jO* Oi <i>* i?, i that which she used to worship besides Allah, for she was of a disbelieving people.) What Mujahid and Said said is good) it was also the view of Ibn Jarir.121 Then Ibn Jarir said, "It could be that the subject of the verb. iAnd Saddaha refers to Sulayman or to Allah, so that the phrase now means: Jt iShe would not worship anything over than Allah.) fi o*& %l} ifor she was of a disbelieving people.) I say: the opinion of Mujahid is supported by the fact that she declared her Islam after she entered the Sarh, as we shall see below. Af-Tabari 19:471 Af-Tabari 19 :472

Uii ji-j' U 4/f was said to her: "Enter As-Sarh" but when she saw it, she thought it was a pool, and she (tucked up her clothes) uncovering her legs .) Sulayman had commanded the Shayatin to build for her a huge palace of glass beneath which water was flowing. Anyone who did not know the nature of the building would think that it was water, but in fact there was a layer of glass between a person walking and the water. Verily, it is a SarhMumarrad ofQawdrxr Sarh means a palace or any lofty construction. Allah says of Fir'awn - may Allah curse him - that he said to his minister Haman: iC ££ J\$) iBuild me a Sarh that I may arrive at the ways.) (40:36-37) Syr is also used to refer to the high constructed palaces in Yemen. Mumarrad means sturdily constructed and smooth. itS iof Qawarir) means, made of glass, i.e., it was built with smooth surfaces. Marid is a fortress in Dawmat Al-Jandal.

What is meant here is that Sulayman built a huge, lofty palace

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4195]

of glass for this queen, in order to show her the greatness of his authority and power. When she saw for herself what Allah had given him and how majestic his position was, she submitted to

the command of Allah and acknowledged that he was a noble

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4195–4197]

Prophet, so she submitted to Allah and said: iv>2> 4My Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself,) meaning, by her previous disbelief and Shirk and by the fact that she and her people had worshipped the sun instead of Allah. 4U&' £ lllj) 4and I submit, together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.)

{Then look! They became two parties quarreling with each other.} Mujahid said, "These were believers and disbelievers." 1 11 This is like the Ayah, & ^ £Si; S-i CiyIJ C/J' Jli 4@^i/£' ** Xu'^ tfji di iThe

leaders of those who were arrogant among his people said to those who were counted weak - to such of them as believed "Know you that Salih is one sent from his Lord." They said: "We indeed believe in that with which he has been sent." Those who were arrogant said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that which you believe in."} (7:75-76) - .*.U Jji j >1 -£>*-£ J 4He said: "O my people! Why do you seek to hasten the evil before the good?"} meaning, "why are you praying for the punishment to come, and not asking Allah for His mercy?" Then he said: 4"Why seek you not the forgiveness of Allah, that you may receive mercy?" They said: "We augur an omen from you and those with you."} This means: "We do not see any good in your face and the faces of those who are following you." Since they were doomed, whenever anything bad happened to any of them they would say, "This is because of Salih and his companions." Mujahid said, "They regarded them as bad omens."121 This is similar to

what Allah said about the people of Fir'awn:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4197-4216]

C / s o*J ilLi Jfy .;xi Q \)£ _i#C. 111 At-Tabari 19:475. 121 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :369

iBut whenever good came to them, they said: "Ours is this." And if evil afflicted them, they saw it as an omen about Musa and those with him (7:131). And Allah says: J* ^9 Cit (Hr* 1 j f-9 bt -if ^ i; 4And i/ some good reaches them, they say, "This is from Allah," but if some evil befalls them, they say, "This is from you." Say: "All things arefrom Allah."} (4:78) i.e., by virtue of His will and decree. And Allah tells us about the dwellers of the town, when the Messengers came to them: m t£s J4 q \$t} iThey (people) said: "For us, we see an omenfrom you; ifyou cease not, we will surely stone you, and a painful torment will touch youfrom us." They (Messengers) said: "Your omens are with yourselves!} (36:18) And these people [Thamud] said: JLe jti liLJ >4 i" "We augur an omen from you and those with you." He said: "Your omen is ofAllah;} meaning, Allah will punish you for that. JL* •*% rv inay, but you are a people that are being tested.} Qatadah said: "You are being tested to see whether you will obey or disobey." The apparent meaning of the phrase iare being tested is: you will be left to get carried away in your state ofmisguidance. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :369

t yU 4 <£yi-i Ju»j L»Ii j-.ulM ^ 1^3 %•&&& C4* a^S 2 ^ Lit j»-*£- i-ii <i3li==» J-LIL ^ £i==au i-tf «il'j <j ^3^ tj-jji Lj iijjL- -^UL* X£j<s£r {4*j j f&s 4i@2'^>S^i "y^=='-> £*.& L-Ltflj I^OjilLo ^i) 448. And there were in the city nine Rahtin, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform. 449. They said: "Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household, and thereafter we will surely say to his near relatives: 'We witnessed not the destruction of his household, and verily, we are telling the truth.'" } 450. So, they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not.} 451. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation all together.} 452. These are their houses in utter ruin, for they did wrong. Verily, in this is indeed an Ayah for people who know.} 453. And We saved those who believed, and had Taqwa of Allah.} The Plot of the Mischief-Makers and the End of the People ofThamud Allah tells us about the evildoers of Thamtid and their leaders who used to call their people to misguidance and disbelief, and to deny Salih. Eventually they killed the she-camel and were about to kill Salih too. They plotted to let him sleep with his family at night, then they would assassinate him and tell his relatives that they knew

nothing about what happened to him, and that they were telling the truth because none of them had seen anything. Allah says: 4£.P''' 4 4And there were in the city} meaning, in the city ofThamQd, 4-kiJ il^}

334 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr 4nine Raht,4 meaning, nine people, iwho made mischief in the land, and would not reform. They forced their opinions on the people of Thamud, because they were the leaders and chiefs. Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “These were the people who killed the she- camel,” [11 Meaning, that happened upon their instigation, may Allah curse them. Allah says: c>&pZ 63S> iBut they called their comrade and he took (a sword) and killed (the she-camel).} (54:29) iWhen the most wicked man among them wentforth (to kill the she-camel). (91:12) ‘Abdur-Razzaq said that Yahya bin Rabl‘ah As-San‘ani told them, “I heard ‘Ata’ - i.e. Ibn Abi Rabah - say: 4And there were in the city nine Raht, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform. They used to break silver coins.’ ”*21 They would break off pieces from them, as if they used to trade with them in terms ofnumbers [as opposed to weight], as the Arabs used to do. Imam Malik narrated from Yahya bin Said that Said bin Al- Musayyib said: “Cutting gold and silver (coins) is part of spreading corruption on earth.” What is meant is that the nature of these evil disbelievers was to spread corruption on earth by every means possible, one of which was that mentioned by these Imams. 4p\j iThey said: "Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household . m At-Tabari 19:477. Abdur-Razzaq 3 :83

335Surah 27. An-Naml (48 - 53) (Part-19) They took a mutual oath, pledging that during the night, whoever met the Allah’s Prophet Salih, peace be upon him, he would assassinate him. But Allah planned against them and caused their plot to backfire. Mujahid said, “They took a mutual oath pledging to kill him, but before they could reach him, they and their people were sill destroyed.” ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Hatim121 said: “When they killed the she-camel, Salih said to them: jjS lej iidl \yClj} 4“Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. Tftis is a promise (i.e., a threat) that will not be belied.”} (11:65). They said: ‘Salih claims that he will finish with us in three days, but we will finish him and his family before the three days are over.’ Salih had a place of worship in a rocky tract in a valley, where he used to pray. So they set out to go to a cave there one night, and said, When he comes to pray, we will kill him, then we will return. When we have finished him off, we will go to his family and finish them off too.’ Then Allah sent down a rock upon them from the mountains round about; they feared that it would crush them, so they ran into the cave and the rock covered the mouth of the cave while they were inside. Their people did not know where they were or what had happened to them. So Allah punished some of them here, and some of them there, and He saved Salih and the people who were with him. Then he recited: jji£ 4 f-tr’J?. <34^ (igPoi l-1' 4So, they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation, all together. These are their houses in utter ruin,} i.e., deserted.” 111 At-Tabari 19:478. 121 That is ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd . This narration is recorded by Ibn Abi H&tim no. 16485, and At-Tabari no. 27054.

upon him, and how he warned his people of Allah’s punishment for committing an act of immorality which no human ever committed before them - intercourse with males instead of females. This is a major sin, whereby men are satisfied with men and women are with women (i.e. homosexuality). Lut said: 4Do you commit immoral sins ivhile you see?} meaning, “while you see one another, and you

practice every kind of evil in your meetings.' pf & fe)» <6*&X#^ pfr iDo you practice your lusts on men instead of women? Nay, but you are a people who behave senselessly.} means, "you do not know anything of what is natural or what is prescribed by Allah.' This is like the Ayah: P P 3? u& ^Go you in unto the males of mankind, and leave those whom Allah has created far you to be your wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people!} (26:165-166) iThere was no other answer given by his people except that they said: "Drive out the family of Lut from your city. Verily, these are men who want to be clean and pure!"} means, "they feel embarrassed because of the deeds you are doing, and because you approve of your actions, so expel them from among yourselves, for they are not fit to live among you in your city.' So, the people resolved to do that, and Allah destroyed them, and a similar end awaits the disbelievers. Allah says: 4So, We saved him and his family, except his wife. We

^Praise and thanks be to Allah,} meaning, for His innumerable blessings upon His servants and for His exalted Attributes and most beautiful Names. And He commands him to send peace upon the servants of Allah whom He chose and selected, i.e., His noble Messengers and Prophets, may the best of peace and blessings from Allah be upon them. This was the view of 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others; the meaning of the servants He has chose is the Prophets. He said, "This like He said in the Ayah; C,j & & {Glorified be your Lord, the Lor\$ of honor and power! (He is free) from what they attribute unto Him! And peace be on the Messengers! And all the praises and thanks be to Allah, Lord of all that exists.} (37:180-182)." Ath-Thawri and As-Suddi said, "This refers to the Companions of Muhammad may Allah be pleased with them all." Something similar was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, and there is no contradiction between the two views, because they were also among the servants of Allah whom He had chosen, although the description is more befitting of the Prophets. i&Xg ft% &' -} }Is Allah better, or what they ascribe as partners (to Him)?} This is' a question aimed at denouncing the idolators for their worship of other gods besides Allah. Some more Proofs of Tawhld Then Allah begins to explain that He is the Only One Who creates, provides and controls, as He says: {Is not He Who created the heavens} meaning. He created those heavens which are so high and serene, with their shining stars and revolving planets. And He created the earth, with its varying heights and densities, and He created everything in it, mountains, hills, plains, rugged terrain, wildernesses, crops, trees, fruits, seas and animals of

4\$-£i ^ 3^ 4Nay, but they are a people who ascribe equals (to Him)!} meaning, they describe others as being equal and comparable to Allah. J"- City jj ^ aJJ \yX~ 461 . Is not He Who has made the earth as a fixed abode, and has placed rivers in its midst, and has placed firm mountains therein, and has set a barrier between the two seas (of salt and sweet water)? Is there any ilah (god) with Allah? Nay, but most of them know not!} Allah says: o&t j^-£} 4Is not He Who has made the earth as a fixed abode,} meaning, stable and stationary, so that it does not move or convulse, because if it were to do so, it would not be a good place for people to live on. But by His grace and mercy. He has made it smooth and calm, and it is not shaken or moved. This is like the Ayah, iAlldh, Who has made for you the earth as a dwelling place and the sky as a canopy} (40:64). 4and has placed rivers in its midst,} means, He has placed rivers which are fresh and sweet, cutting through the earth, and He has made them of different types, large rivers, small rivers and some in between. He has caused them to flow in all directions, east, west, south, north, according to the needs of mankind in different areas and regions, as

He has created them throughout the world and sends them their provision according to their needs. and has placed firm mountains therein,}

342 Tafsir Ibn Kathir means, high mountains which stabilize the earth and make it steadfast, so that it does not shake. and has set a barrier between the two seas} means, He has placed a barrier between the fresh water and the salt water, to prevent them from mixing lest they corrupt one another. Divine wisdom dictates that each of them should stay as it is meant to be. The sweet water is that which flows in rivers among mankind, and it is meant to be fresh and palatable so that it may be used to water animals and plants and fruits. The salt water is that which surrounds the continents on all sides, and its water is meant to be salty and undrinkable lest the air be corrupted by its smell, as Allah says: £\$ & ' & > 4 And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter; and He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} (25:53) Allah says: 4\$£ & } } 41\$ there any god with Allah?} meaning, any god who could do this, or who deserves to be worshipped? Both meanings are indicated by the context. tips 1pu & } 4 Nay, but most of them know not!} means, in that they worship others than Allah. P g ZJj JcSp \ \ jiitf dJ p } 462. Is not He Who responds to the distressed one, when he calls on Him, and Who removes the evil, and makes you inheritors of the earth, generations after generations? Is there any god with Allah? Little is that you remember!} Allah points out that He is the One upon Whom people call in times of difficulty, and He is the One to Whom they turn when

343 Surah 27. An-Naml (62) (Part-20) calamity strikes, as He says elsewhere Vi ,v L. ti ^ And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him^ (17:67), iThen, when harm touches you, unto Him you cry aloud for help (16:53). Similarly, Allah says here: iiz SUX ±4.4} ils not He Who responds to the distressed one, when he calls on Him,} meaning. Who is the only One to Whom the person in desperate need turns, and the only One Who can relieve those who are stricken by harm? Imam Ahmad reported that a man of Balhajlm said: “O Messenger of Allah, what are you calling for?” He said: o,i,Ui jl ^jjlj nilp kJCS tijeJi ~jJ> villi jj IjJ~j & \ ®*ll) vLwl £3* .IliLxt jl jA • * ' ' ' ' 0 0 «/ am calling people to Allah Alone, the One Who, if you call on Him when harm befalls you, will relieve you; and when you are lost in the wilderness, you call on Him and He brings you back: and when drought (famine) strikes, you call on Him and He makes your crops grow. He said: “Advise me.” He \$g| said: <1>1 Ljll C-j\j iitif jt jij yji OXAJi 'Ij 'l/ 8 4 JI^Jl 4[jj*0 jUJ ^ ji 'fij Ajipr} n an jp iL>Ji j, /y{\ jpi j^ jO'ji Jpp Istfp ^4 «£ujl iiDo not slander anyone and do not think of any good deed as insignificant, even if it is only meeting your brother with a cheerful face or emptying your vessel into the vessel of one who is asking for water. Wear your lower garment at mid-calf

344 Tafsir Rm Kathir length, or - if you insist - let it reach your ankles, and beware of lowering the garment below the ankles along the ground,111 for it is a form of showing-off, and Allah does not like showing-off. b'21 The Story of a Mujahid who fought for the sake of Allah In his biography of Fatimah bint Al-Hasan Umm Ahmad Al- 'Ajaliyyah, Al-Hafiz bin 'Asakir reported that she said: “One day the disbelievers defeated the Muslims in a battle. There was a good horse which belonged to a rich man who was also righteous. The horse just stood there, so its owner said, “What is the matter with you? Woe to you! I was only preparing you for a day such as this.’ The horse said to him: *How can you expect me not to perform badly, when you delegated my feeding to the grooms, and they mistreated me

and only fed me a little?' The man said, 'I make you a promise before Allah that from this day on, only I will feed you from my own lap.' So the horse began to run, and his owner was saved, and after that he only ever fed the horse from his own lap. This story became well known among the people, and they started to come to him to hear the story from his own lips. News of this reached the king of Byzantium, and he said: 'A city where this man is, will be kept safe from harm.' He wanted to bring the man to his own city, so he sent an apostate (a man who had left Islam) who was living in his city to go to him, and when he reached him, he pretended that his intentions towards Islam and its followers were good, so the Mujahid trusted him. One day they went out walking along the shore, but the apostate made a pact with another person, a follower of the Byzantine king, to come and help him take the Mujahid prisoner. When they made their move, he lifted his gaze to the sky and said, 'O Allah! He has deceived me by swearing in Your Name, so protect me in whatever way You will.' Then two wild animals came out and seized them, and the Mujahid came back safe and sound." 3' To let one's lower garment trail along the ground. ' Ahmad 5 :64. This narration is not authentic. Most parts of the text are found in other authentic Hadiths. ' TOrtkh Dimashq 19 :489 MS

The Inheritance of the Earth and makes you inheritors of the earth, means, each generation inherits from the generation that came before them, one after the other, as Allah says: *And We will destroy you, and in your place make whom We will as your successors, as We raised you from the seed of other people (6:133), and it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth. And He has raised you in ranks, some above others (6:165), and (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Verily, I am going to place generations after generations on earth." (2:30) meaning, people who will come after one another, as we have already stated. Allah's saying: and makes you inheritors of the earth, means, nation after nation, generation after generation, people after people. If He had willed, He could have created them all at one time, and not made some of them the offspring of others. If He had willed. He could have created them all together, as He created Adam from dust. If He had willed. He could have made some of them the offspring of others, but not caused any of them to die until they all died at one time; in this case the earth would have become constricted for them and it would be too difficult for them to live and earn a living, and they would have caused inconvenience and harm to one*

347 Surah 27. An-Naml (63 - 64) (Part-20) And landmarks and by the stars, they guide And We will destroy you, and in your place make whom We will as your successors, as We raised you from the seed of other people (6:133), and it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth. And He has raised you in ranks, some above others (6:165), and (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Verily, I am going to place generations after generations on earth." (2:30) meaning, people who will come after one another, as we have already stated. Allah's saying: and makes you inheritors of the earth, means, nation after nation, generation after generation, people after people. If He had willed, He could have created them all at one time, and not made some of them the offspring of others. If He had willed. He could have created them all together, as He created Adam from dust. If He had willed. He could have made some of them the offspring of others, but not caused any of them to die until they all died at one time; in this case the earth would have become constricted for them and it would be too difficult for them to live and earn a living, and they would have caused inconvenience and harm to one

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4Say "Bring forth your proofs, if you are truthful."} Produce the evidence of that. But it is known that they have no proof or evidence, as Allah says: cU * & ** te* 4 tf 0% * >C & £g 4And whoever invokes besides Allah, any other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers will not be successful.} (23:117) (** <jj £* j4 4 ^65. Say: "None in the heavens and the earth knows the Unseen except Allah, nor can they perceive when they shall be resurrected."} 466. Nay, their knowledge will perceive that in the Hereafter. Nay, they are in doubt about it. Nay, they are in complete blindness about it.} The One Who knows the Unseen is Allah Allah commands His Messenger ig to inform all of creation that no one among the dwellers of heaven and earth knows the Unseen, except Allah. i'Ji 4except Allah This is an absolute exception, meaning that no one knows this besides Allah, He is alone in that regard, having no partner in that knowledge. This is like the Ayat 4% 4And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them but He} (6:59). 4Z3\ Jffc jaaf£ 2f l[] 4Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain} (31:34). until the end of the Surah. And there are many Ayat which mention similar things.

£\$ Cf} inor can they perceive when they shall be resurrected.} That is, the created beings who dwell in the heavens and on earth do not know when the Hour will occur, as Allah says: iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden (7:187). meaning, it is a grave matter for the dwellers of heaven and earth. 4& iNay, their knowledge will perceive that in the Hereafter. Nay, they are in doubt about it.} means their knowledge and amazement stops short of knowing its time. Other scholars read this with the meaning "their knowledge is all the same with regard to that," which reflects

the meaning of the Haddith in Sahth. Muslim which states that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4216–4217]

the Messenger of Allah sg said to Jibril, when the latter asked him when the Hour would come: ijnui ja ^1 u» iThe one who is being asked about it does not know any more than the one who is asking .n In other words, they were both equal in the fact that their knowledge did not extend that far. 4^ 4 iNay, they are in doubt about it.} This refers to the disbelievers in general as Allah says elsewhere: £3 S4 J^ j; £ \$ US' 52 4; £ \^} iAnd they will be set before your Lord in rows, (and Allah will say:) "Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time. Nay, but you thought that We had appointed no m Muslim 1 :36.

352Surah 27. An-Naml (67 - 70) (Part-20 meeting for you (with Us)."} (18:48) i.e., the disbelievers among you. By the same token, Allah says here: iNay, they are in doubt about it.} meaning, they doubt that it will come to pass. ,» iNay, they are in complete blindness about it.} They are blind and completely ignorant about it. js i 4wz <o&4& Jfjii j lt£— J* V) Ui j; 4 -v' <j (*+^ ii/J* Vj 467. And those who disbelieve say: "When we have become dust - we and our fathers - shall we really be brought forth?"} 168. "Indeed we were protised this - we and our forefathers before, verily, these are nothing but tales of ancients."} 169. Say to them: "Travel in the land and see how has been

the end of the criminals."}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4217–4240]

170. And grieve you not over them, nor be straitened (in distress) because of what they plot.} Scepticism about the Resurrection and Its Refutation Allah tells us about the idolaters who deny the Resurrection, considering it extremely unlikely that bodies will be re-created after they have become bones and dust. Then He says: 4Jr* tj&y yi- UC» IjJej Xd} indeed we were promised this - we and our forefathers before,} meaning, 'we and our forefathers have been hearing this for a long time, but in reality, we have never seen it happen.' iup % Qi& verily, these are nothing but tales of ancients.} the promises that bodies will be restored are

i'4p 4nothing but tales of ancients.} meaning that they were taken by the people who came before us from books which were handed down from one to the other, but they have no basis in reality. Responding to their thoughts of disbelief and their belief that there would be no Resurrection, Allah said, 43^ 4Sm/^ 'O Muhammad, to these people,' iTravel in the land and see how has been the end of the criminals.} meaning, those who denied the Messengers and their message of the Resurrection and other matters. See how the punishment and vengeance of Allah struck them and how Allah saved from among them the noble Messengers and the believers who followed them. This will be an indication of the truth of the Message brought by the Messengers. Then, to comfort the Prophet Jg, Allah says: l-Z%} 4And grieve you not over them,} meaning, "but do not feel sorry for them or kill yourself with regret for them," 4nor be straitened because of what they plot.} means, because they plot against you and reject what you have brought, for Allah will help and support you, and cause your religion to prevail over those who oppose you and stubbornly resist you in the east and in the west.' 471. And they say: "When this promise, if you are truthful?"} 472. Say: "Perhaps that which you wish to hasten on, may be

close behind you.") 473. Verily, your Lord is full of grace for mankind, yet most of them do not give thanks. 474. And verily, your Lord knows what their breasts conceal and what they reveal.} 475. And there is nothing hidden in the heaven and the earth but it is in a Clear Book.} Allah tells us about how the idolaters asked about the Day of Resurrection, but thought it unlikely that it would ever come to pass. / c s . / V // // / > \ * - V,- ifl-i O) '-C* JJyjj} iAnd they say "When (will) this promise (be fulfilled), if you are truthful?"} Allah said, responding to them: 43ft 4Say} 'O Muhammad,' Jjj bfoi J 4Perhaps that which you wish to hasten on, may be close behind you.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "That which you wish to hasten on has come close to you, or some of it has come close."111 This was also the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, 'Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi. 121 This is also what is meant in the Ayat && ol^ ji %£ 4And they say: "When will that be?" Say: "Perhaps it is near!"} (17:51) 4They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily, Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers} (29:54). ip J At-Jabari 19:492. At-Tabari 19 :492 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :375

355 Surah 27. An-Naml (76 - 81) (Part-20) J XM ^1\$oip'i^T uj 1 Laj >1 * ' -V-I-'ijj^ -j oU ^ W>- ^j4r^djii'^Sj (j^L-iu jla!Liel^). (3^iIsjj*^":A^=>1J IS j3'&P lixdte; ^_43_j^J 'j^cij^)_)^ ^ii!^u ^<m the heaven and the earth but it is in a Clear Book.} This is like the Ayah, 4 £ p£ ait ru i»> 4 <3b oi JfeSf ail <£ 4-i 51, iKnow you not that Allah knows all that is in the heaven and on the earth? Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easy for Allah.} (22:70) £ J*k itfyfi & a-i ji» jM _A^=>! diCr'l fa »a" /< , Tf7^

- >/' '—^y o| vv.u^f >\$>' J*» **•£«* (4^ i»» <> j& iSA^ Ca^ ty ^>OWJa 'jb «iejji ^£}f ^ ^ <5^ V viC! <>»)* jc pi* Se*j (>* '!) oj JLg&S jt ylil' 476. Verily, this Qur'an narrates to the Children of Israel most of that in which they differ.} 477. And truly, it is a guide and a mercy for the believers.} }78. Verily, your Lord will decide between them by His judgement. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing.} 479. So, put your trust in Allah; surely, you are on manifest truth.} 480. Verily, you cannot make the dead to hear nor can you make the deaf to hear the call, when they flee, turning their

backs. 481 . Nor can you lead the blind out of their error. You can only make to hear those who believe in Our Ayat, so they submit (became Muslims).} The Qur'an tells the Story of the Differences among the Children of Israel, and Allah judges between them. Allah tells us about His Book and the guidance, proof and criterion between right and wrong that it contains. He tells us about the Children of Israel, who were the bearers of the Tawrah and Injil. 4 most of that in which they differ.} such as their different opinions about 'Isa. The Jews lied about him while the Christians exaggerated in praise for him, so the Qur'an came with the moderate word of truth and justice: that he was one of the servants of Allah, and one of His noble Prophets and Messengers, may the best of peace and blessings be upon him, as the Qur'an says: '(-j* •J- u-k 4 Such is 'Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a statement of truth, about which they doubt} (19:34). tS-jj <j'A fy} 4 And truly, it is a guide and a mercy for the believers.} meaning, it is guidance for the hearts of those who believe in it, and a mercy to them. Then Allah says: isik i Verily, your Lord will decide between them} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, jij 4 by His judgement. And He is the All-Mighty,} means, in His vengeance,

it the All-Knowing.} Who knows all that His servants do and say. The Command to put One's Trust in Allah and to convey the Message i So, put your trust in Allah;} in all your affairs, and convey the Message of your Lord. 4*3\$££ &\} surely, you are on manifest truth.} meaning, you are following manifest truth, even though you are opposed by those who oppose you because they are doomed. The Word of your Lord has been justified against them, so that they will not believe even if all the signs are brought to them. Allah says: 44P' V i Verily, you cannot make the dead to hear} meaning, you cannot cause them to hear anything that will benefit them. The same applies to those over whose hearts is a veil and in whose ears is deafness of disbelief. Allah says: **! > .1 • x „ / t:y ItfZ \js ty sit p>'y -ij} p-f* 0'S. or in or can you make the deaf to hear the call, when they flee, turning their backs. Nor can you lead the blind out of their error. You can only make to hear those who believe in Our Ayat, so they submit (became Muslims).} meaning, those who have hearing and insight will respond to you, those whose hearing and sight are of benefit to their hearts and who are humble towards Allah and to the Message that comes to them through the mouths of the Messengers, may peace be upon them. *m ix u 4x2 s Xu p y^ >. > 482. And when the Word is fulfilled against them, We shall bring out from the earth a beast for them, to speak to them because mankind believed not with certainty in Our Ayat.}

Hasan Sahth.” ' ' It was also recorded by Muslim from Hudhayfah in a Marfu' report.¹² ' And Allah knows best. Another Hadith Muslim bin Al-Hajjaj recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said, “I memorized a Hadith from the Messenger of Allah jg which I never forgot afterwards. I heard the Messenger of Allah sg£ say: tCj U Jj biitf li v The first of the signs to appear will be the rising of the sun from the west, and the emergence of the beast to mankind in the forenoon . Whichever of them appears first, the other will follow close behind if.®' Another Hadith In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah,

may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: jljJlj bJU-jJIJ b b VJjAA b bJl^pS/L ^Aa LbJ I JI b ^Hasten to do good deeds before six things appear : the rising of the sun from the west; the smoke; the Dajjal; the beast; the (death) of one of your favorite, or general affliction .» This was recorded by Muslim alone.'4 ' Muslim also recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the the Prophet% said: {j ^-,-1 1 (JL^pS/U «Hasten to do good deeds before six things appear: the Dajjal; Muslim 4 :2225 , Abu Dawud 4 :491 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :413 , An- Nasal in in Al-Kubra 6 :456, Ibn Majah 2 :1341 ' Muslim 4:2226. Marfu' meaning a Hadith referred to the Prophet ' Muslim 4 :2260 ' Muslim 4:2267.

will make the face of the believer bright with the staff, until when people gather for a meal, they will say to one another, O believer, or O disbeliever It was also recorded by Ibn MajahJ Ibn Jurayj reported that Ibn Az-Zubayr described the beast and said, "Its head is like the head of a bull, its eyes are like the eyes of a pig, its ears are like the ears of an elephant, its horns are like the horns of a stag, its neck is like the neck of an ostrich, its chest is like the chest of a lion, its color is like the colour of a tiger, its haunches are like the haunches of a cat, its tail is like the tail of a ram, and its legs are like the legs of a camel. Between each pair of its joints is a distance of twelve cubits. It will bring out with it the staff of Musa and the ring of Sulayman. There will be no believer left without it making a white spot on his face, which will spread until all his face is shining white as a result; and there will be no disbeliever left without it making a black spot on his face, which will spread until all his face is black as a result, then when the people trade with one another in the marketplace, they will say, How much is this, O believer?' 'How much is this, O disbeliever?' And when the members of one household sit down together to eat, they will know who is a believer and who is a disbeliever. Then the beast will say: 'O so-and-so, enjoy yourself, for you are among the people of Paradise.' And it will say: 'O so-and-so, you are among the people of Hell,' This is what Allah says: V jlt p £>1^ g £0 f S > . y 4And when the Word is fulfilled against them, We shall bring out from the earth a beast for them, to speak to them because mankind believed not with certainty in Our Ayat.^ [3] Jt* jX*. IjJ yr** & ^-4-* ^ (***)• 1,1 Ahmad 2:295. 121 Ibn Majah 2:1351. ,31 AlBaghwi 3:429.

4 dji 1 ->W^b aJ jff Lilil Q _jii ^ jl * y •; 4&3. And (remember) the Day when We shall gather out of every nation a Fawj of those who denied Our Ayat, and they shall be driven,} 484. Till, when they come. He will say: "Did you deny My Ayat whereas you comprehended them not by knowledge, or what was it that you used to do?"} 485. And the Word will be fulfilled against them, because they have done wrong, and they will be unable to speak.} 486. See they not that We have made the night for them to rest therein, and the day sight-giving? Verily, in this are Ayat for the people who believe.} Gathering the Wrongdoers on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about the Day of Resurrection when the wrongdoers who disbelieved in the signs and Messengers of Allah will be gathered before Allah, so that He will ask them about what they did in this world, rebuking, scolding and belittling them. pi '£}} 4And the Day when We shall gather out of every nation, a Fawj} means, from every people and generation a group 4fe\$£i L>'&> J^} 4of those who denied Our Ayat}. This is like the Ayat !& 4"Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions (from the devils)." (37:22) 4And when the souls are joined with their bodies} (81:7). A V

and they shall be driven, Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “They will be pushed.” 11 ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: “They will be driven.” 12 Till, when they come,} and stand before Allah, may He glorified and exalted, in the place of reckoning, be 4 He will say: "Did you deny My Ayat whereas you comprehended them not by knowledge, or what was it that you used to do?"} meaning they will be asked about their beliefs and their deeds. Since they are among the doomed and, as Allah says: 4 He neither believed nor performed Salah! But on the contrary, he denied and turned away!} (75 :31 -32) Then the proof will be established against them and they will have no excuse whatsoever, as Allah says: bzti-sfi *4 riX iThat will be a Day when they shall not speak. And they will not be permitted to put forth any excuse} (77 :35-36). Similarly, Allah says here: iAnd the Word will be fulfilled against them, because they have done wrong, and they will be unable to speak.} They will be stunned and speechless, unable to give any answer. This is because they wronged themselves in the world, and now they have returned to the One Who sees the unseen and the seen, from Whom nothing can be hidden. Then Allah points out His complete power, immense authority and greatness, all dictating that He is to be obeyed 111 At-Tabari 19:501. 121 At-Tabari 19:438.

and that His commands must be followed, and that the message of inescapable truth brought by His Prophets must be believed in. Allah says: J3f LiX 0 i£ tfiei/ not that We have made the night for them to rest therein, Due to the darkness of the night they halt their activities and calm themselves down, to recover from the exhausting efforts of the day. iand the day sight- meaning filled with light, so that they can work and earn a living, and travel and engage in business, and do other things that they need 'to do. giving) iVerily, in this are Aydtfor the people who believe.) •J3' iXj y "3\ Jfjy\ ^ oylllf ti y ^ A& '\$0 ~4\A& >;axp Jdf Jb ity. & ii i+j& J&- PX a; ^ aXX # 6 *5i ji 4 ^ 487. And (remember) the Day on which the Trumpet (Sur) will

365 Surah 27. An-Naml (87 - 90) (Part-20) be blown - and all who are in the heavens and all who are on the earth, will be terrified except him whom Allah wills. And all shall come to Him, humbled.} 488. And you will see the mountains and think them solid, but they shall pass away as the passing away of the clouds. The work of Allah, Who perfected all things, verily, He is well- acquainted with what you do.} 489. Whoever brings a good deed, will have better than its worth; and they will be safe from the terror on that Day.} 490. And whomever brings an evil deed, they will be cast down on their faces in the Fire. (And it will be said to them) "Are you being recompensed anything except what you used to do?"} The Terrors of the Day of Resurrection, the Rewards for Good Deeds and the Punishments for Evil Deeds Allah tells us about the terrors of the Day when the Sur will be blown. The Sur, as described in the Hadith, is, (Jji 3 ofl hom which is blown into) According to the Hadith about the Sur (Trumpet), it is (the angel) Isra'il who will blow into it by the command of Allah, may He be exalted. He will blow into it for the first time, for a long time. This will signal the end of the life of this world, and the Hour will come upon the most evil of people ever to live. Everyone who is in the heavens and on earth will be terrified, 4& £%} 4except him whom Allah wills.} these are the martyrs, for they are alive, with their Lord, and being provided for. Imam Muslim bin Al-Hajjaj recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, said that a man came to him and said, “What is this Hadith that you are narrating, that the Hour will come upon such and such people?” He said, “Subhan Allah or ‘La Haha IUaJlah (or something similar), I had decided t 1 ' See volume two , the Tafstr of Surah Al ‘Imran (3 :169)

nimble as birds and will be more temperamental than wild beasts. They will not recognize anything good or denounce anything evil. The Shaytan will appear to them and will say, "Will you do as I tell you?" They will say, "What do you command us to do?" He will command them to worship idols but in spite of this their provision will be plentiful and they will lead comfortable lives. Then the Sur (Trumpet) will be blown, and no one will hear it but he will tilt his head to hear the sound. The first person to hear it will be a man who is setting up the tank for watering his camels. He will fall down, and all the other people will also fall down. Then Allah will send - or send down - rain like dew - or he said, like shade (Nu'mdn was the one who was not sure) - from which will grow the bodies of the people. Then the Trumpet will be blown again, and they will get up and look around. Then it will be said: "O mankind! Go to your Lord!" And they will be stopped, for they are to be questioned. Then it will be said: "Bring forth the people who are to be sent to the Fire." It will be asked: "How many are they?" It will be said, "Out of every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine." That will be the Day which will make the children grey-headed, and that will be the Day when the Shin shall be uncovered.*' His saying; •bJ j bJ ^| - ^ 'Then the Sur (Trumpet) will be blown, and no one will hear it but he will tilt his head to hear the sound. means that they will tilt their heads so that they can better hear the sound coming from the heavens. That is the blast of the Sur which will terrify everyone, then after that will come the blast which will cause them to die, then the blast which will resurrect them to meet the Lord of the worlds - this is when all of the creation will be brought forth from their graves. Allah says: yd iAnd all shall come to Him, humbled. meaning, humbling 111 Muslim 4:2258.

themselves and obeying Him, and no one will go against His command. This is like the Ayat. iOn the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with His praise and obedience> (17:52). a Mlj) dfjil ^ ijtJ Ij) 'f) iThen afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth) (30:25). According to the Hadith about the Stir, when it is blown for the third time, Allah will command the souls to be put into the hole of the Sur (Trumpet), then Israfil will blow into it, after the bodies have grown in their graves and resting places, and when he blows into the Sur (Trumpet), the souls will fly, the believers' souls glowing with light, and the disbelievers' souls looking like darkness. And Allah will say: "By My might and majesty, every soul will go back to its body." And the souls will come back to their bodies and go through them like poison going through a person who is bitten or stung by a poisonous creature. Then they will get up, brushing off the dirt of their graves. Allah says: J] &r} * ... \ iThe Day when they will come out of the graves quickly as racing to a goal.) (70:43) tyUdi s jell dljj))And you will see the mountains and think them solid, but they shall pass away as the passing away of the clouds.) (27:88) meaning, you will see them as if they are fixed and as if they will remain as they are, but they will pass away as the passing away of the clouds, i.e., they will move away from their places. * I At-Tabarfini in At-Tiwal 36. The author is referring to an unauthentic Hadith. Most of the scholars say that the Sur will be blown two times, based upon the authentic Hadiths, including those seen in this discussion

This is like the Ayat. 4On the Day when the heaven will shake with a dreadful shaking. And the mountains will move away with a (horrible) movement.)) (52:9-10) (cl5 lijJLj jf) Jii t)JA if JkJ&j) imX% £e iAnd they ask you concerning the mountains : say, "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust. Then He shall leave them as a level smooth plain. You will see therein nothing crooked or curved.") (20:105-107), isn't* ijij Jui1 jf pjijjf iAnd (remember) the Day We shall cause the

mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a leveled plain.) (18:47). , , i£\$ \$ && 4The work of Allah, Who perfected all things,) means, He does that by His great power. ^Who perfected all things,) means, He has perfected all that He has created, and has fashioned it according to His wisdom. iverily, He is well-acquainted with what you do) means, He knows all that His servants do, good or evil, and He will reward or punish them accordingly. Then Allah describes the state of the blessed and the doomed on that Day, and says: 4& %- % *& 4Whoever brings a good deed, will have better than its worth.) Qatadah said, "That is sincerely for Allah alone." 111 Allah has 111 At-Tabarani 19:508.

\$93. And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah. He will show you His Ayat, and you shall recognize them. And your Lord is not unaware of wltw you do."4 The Command to worship Allah and to call People with the Qur'an Allah commands His Messenger jfe to say: i;-j.=%=% 4' ^&& 3 m 41 have been commanded only to worship the Lord of this city, Who has sanctified it and to Whom belongs everything.} This is like the Ayah, xfi jjj ce, -4 tji1 oi 4" 4 '4 ' kt 4'7&r. lijl' 4Sai/ : "O i/oh mankind! If you are in doubt as to my religion, then (know that) I will never worship tlwse whom you worship besides Allah. But I worship Allah Who causes you to die.} (10:104) The fact that the word "Robb" (Lord) is connected to the word city (in the phrase "the Lord of this city") is a sign of honor and divine care for that city. This is like the Ayah, 4So let them worship the Lord of this House (the Ka'bah), Who has fed them against hunger, and lias made them safe from fear.} (106:3-4) 4^ 4Who has sanctified it} means, the OneWho made it a sanctuary by His Law and by His decree, making it sanctified. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn 'Abbas said: "On the day of the conquest of Makkah, the Messenger of Allah jg said: JI 4)1 II 4)1 JLH l-i* jl® Tj -fi Nj «LaS L4 i) % i) /J4 1X1 <i .uail «Verily, this city was made sacred by Allah the day He

created the heavens and the earth, so it is sacred by the sanctity of Allah until the Day of Resurrection. Its thorny bushes should not be cut, its game should not be chased, and its lost property should not be picked up except by one who would announce it publicly and none is allowed to uproot its thorny shrubs...*"11 This was reported in Sahih, Hasan, Musnad narrations, through various routes, by such a large group that it is absolutely unquestionable, 121 as has been explained in the appropriate place in the book Al-Ahkam, to Allah is the praise and thanks. iand to Wlwm belongs everything.} This is a statement of general application following a specific statement, i.e., He is the Lord of this city, and the Lord and Sovereign of all things, there is no god worthy of worship besides Him. & sjrf iJ Lpy) AAnd I am commanded to befrom among the Muslims.} means, those who believe in Allah alone, who are sincere towards Him and who obediently follow His commands. AAnd that I should recite the Qur'an,} means, to people, so as to convey it to them. This is like the Ayah, AThis is what We recite to you of the Ayat and the Wise Rejoinder.} (3:58) AWe recite to you some of the news of Musa and Fir'awn in truth.} (28:3) meaning, 1 am a conveyer and a wamer.' FathAl-Ban 4:56. 121 Muslim 2:986, Abu Dawud 2:517, An-Nasal 5:203, Ibn Majah 2:1038, Ahmad 1 :253.

j* b* Lit Jit .iJuJ liXf. ££ &Jklkt ^i} 4then whosoever receives guidance, receives it for the good of himself; and whosoever goes astray, say (to him): "I am only one of the wamers."} meaning, *1 have an example to follow in the Messengers who warned their people, and did what they had to do in order to convey the Message to them and fulfil the covenant they had made.' Allah will judge their nations to whom they were sent, as He says: £& gif <%) iyour duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning>

(13 :40). f i'J-\$£% ii 4But you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Protector over all thing (11:12). i&JZ k& 4And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah. He will show you His Ayat (signs), and you shall recognize them.} means, praise be to Allah, Who does not punish anyone except after establishing plea against him, warning him [and leaving him with no excuse]. Allah says: 4He will show you His Ayat (signs), and you sltall recognize them.} This is like the Ayah, ^ .bl jvJJ OO, tfp. Cp.iit X^} ' (4, bbi.'* T-HS—*} 4We will show them Our signs in the universe, and in themselves, until it becomes manifest to them that this is the truth} (41 :53). lit bb) Cj} 4And your Lord is not unaware ofwlrnt you do.} means, on the contrary, He witnesses and sees all things. It

374 Tafslr Ibt Kathlr was recorded that Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy upon him, used to recite the following two lines of verse, whether they were written by him or someone else: “Ifyou are alone one day, do not say, 1 am alone.’ Rather say, ‘Someone is watching me.’ Do not think that Allah will let His attention wander for even an instant, or that anything is hidden from Him.”

Surah 28: Al-Qasas

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 7

PDF pages: 4241–4322

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4241–4253]

Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Ma'diykarib said: "We came to 'Abdullah and asked him to recite to us: Ta Sin Mim .> the two hundred. He said, I do not know it; you should go to someone who learned it from the Messenger of Allah jg Khabbab bin Al-Aratt.' So we went to Khabbab bin Al-Aratt and he recited it to us, may Allah be pleased with him."111 i-sg* ^JSfP*— ^ Ahmad 1 :419. There is a deficiency in the chain of narrators. It also appears to be about Surat AshShu'ara' (26) which contains two hundred and twenty-seven Ayat. However Ibn Kathir mentions a narration about Ibn Mas'Od's recitation of the twentieth Ayah of Ash-Shu'ara', indicating that he did know that Surah, yet that narration, recorded by At-Jabari and others is, like this one, not authentic. Allah knows best.

376 Tgi In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. (fry p OJ <&, |U>l4 gJi lift » L-i t+U.1 oj'Wf i| Cf>> ^Vfo <£if ££ o' ijs &Z&M U& k '?&> S** '4> ^Vf %*UJ\$ ill 4i ,4L 41 . Ta Sin Mim} 42 . These are the Ayat of the manifest Book.} <3. We recite to you some of the news of Musa and Fir'awn in truth, for a people who believe.} 44. Verily, Fir'awn exalted himself in the land and made its people Shtya'a, weakening a group among them: killing their sons, and letting their females live. Verily, he was of the mischief-makers \$> 45 . And We wished to do a favor to tlwse who were weak in the land, and to make them rulers and to make them the inheritors,} 46. And to establish them in the land, and We let Fir'awn and Hdmdn and their armies receive from than that which they feared.} The Story of Musa and Fir'awn, and what Allah intended for Their Peoples We have already discussed the significance of the separate letters. 4uO' «£4' 4These are the Ayat of the manifest Book.} means the Book which is clear and makes plain the true reality of things, and tells us about what happened and what will happen. fry P fr 4We recite to you some of the news of MUsd and Fir'awn in truth,}

377 Surah 28. Al-Qasas Cl - 6) (Part-20) This is like the Ayah, }V\!e relate unto you the best of stories} (12:3). which means, *We tell you about things as they really were, as if you are there and are seeing them yourself.' Then Allah says: 4yjiVf j% iZ&Jl iVerily, Fir'awn exalted himself in the land^ means, he was an arrogant oppressor and tyrant. iattd made its people Shiya'} means, he made them into different classes, each of which he used to do whatever he wanted of the affairs of his state. ifc ijfL iweakening a group among them .} This refers to the Children of Israel, who at that time were the best of people, even though this tyrant king overpowered them, using them to do the most menial work and forcing them to hard labor night and day for him and his people. At the same time, he was killing their sons and letting their daughters live, to humiliate them and because he feared that there might appear among them the boy who would be the cause of his destruction and the downfall of his kingdom. So Fir'awn

took precautions against that happening, by ordering that all boys born to the Children of Israel should be killed, but this precaution did not protect him against the divine decree, because when the term of Allah comes, it cannot be delayed, and for each and every matter there is a decree from Allah. Allah says: *iofti >' o &&& IJj} 4And \Nc wished to do a favor to those who were weak in the land,} until His saying; iwhich theyfeared.} And Allah did indeed do this to them, as He says:*

*t' K' *'•> (JjuJwJ \y iAnd We made the people who were considered weak} until His saying; ithey erected} (7:137). And Allah said: £&j <2\$> iThus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them} (26:59). Fir'awn hoped that by his strength and power he would be saved from Musa, but that did not help him in the slightest. Despite his great power as a king he could not oppose the decree of Allah, which can never be overcome. On the contrary, Allah's ruling was carried out, for it had been written and decreed from past eternity that Fir'awn would meet his doom at the hands of Musa. Vj j),[£ 'i> \ *de ouj- liji j Zsey \$ 2l) C^~y{f} oJlij [IjiifUj !}-» 1Su.^ »•- .1 •>' .< f.'" (/-(>; .1 t ><iuVj ' jl ujuu (jl isr*" V '-yJj <_ * y)£ 47. And We inspired the mother of Musa: "Suckle him (Musa), but when you fearfor him, then cast him into the river and fear not, nor grieve. Verily, We shall bring him back to you, and shall make him one of the Messengers."} i8. Then the household of Fir'awn picked him up, that he might becomefor them an enemy and a (cause of) grief. Verily, Fir'awn, Haman and their armies were sinners.} 49. And the wife of Fir'awn said: "A comfort of the eye for me and for you . Kill him not, perhaps he may be of benefit to us, or we may adopt him as a son ." And they perceived not.} How Musa's Motherwas inspired and shown what to do It was mentioned that when Fir'awn killed so many of the*

males of the Children of Israel, the Copts were scared that the Children of Israel would die out, and they themselves would have to do the heavy labor that the Children of Israel used to do. So they said to Fir'awn, "If this continues, and their old men die and the young men are killed, their women will not be able to do the work that the men are doing, and we will end up having to do it." So Fir'awn issued orders that the boys should be killed one year, and left alone the following year. Harun, peace be upon him, was born in a year when the boys were not killed, and Musa was born in a year when the boys were being killed. Fir'awn had people who were entrusted with this task. There were midwives who would go around and check on the women, and if they noticed that any woman was pregnant, they would write her name down. When the time came for her to give birth, no one was allowed to attend her except for Coptic women. If the woman gave birth to a girl, they would leave her alone and go away, but if she gave birth to a boy, the killers would come in with their sharp knives and kill the child, then they would go away; may Allah curse them. When the mother of Musa became pregnant with him, she did not show any signs of pregnancy as other women did, and none of the midwives noticed. But when she gave birth to a boy, she became very distressed and did not know what to do with him. She was extremely scared for him, because she loved him very much. No one ever saw Musa, peace be upon him, but they loved him, and the blessed ones were those who loved him both as a natural feeling and because he was a Prophet. Allah says: *4And I endued you with lovefrom Me\$ (20:39). Musa, peace be upon him, in the House ofFir'awn When Musa's mother became so worried and confused, it was inspired into her heart and mind what she should do, as Allah says: *Vj . i 4^1\$ c.j Ji Zsty 3* cl) j^*

Fir'awn said: "For you he may be, but not for me. And this was indeed the case: Allah guided her because of him, and destroyed him at his hands. -\ 4perhaps he may be of benefit to us,} This is indeed what happened in her case, for Allah guided her through him and caused her to dwell in Paradise because of him. 4or we may adopt him as a son.} She wanted to take him and adopt him as a son, because she had no children from Fir'awn. V. 4And they perceived not.} means, they did not know what Allah planned for them when they picked him up, by His great wisdom and definitive proof. je tjjLj oi VJJ . fjljJ 1 £ Jlji £^fy} V \$ ^ <* ^ 'T-a\$ & j* <i3Ui at % \<x- .6 ju '\$,*;1 llj, iijjji J) pkj ,U==*J V U Zj 410. And the heart of the mother ofMusa became empty. She was very near to disclose his (case), had We not strengthened her Iteart, so that site might remain as one of the believers.} 411 • And she said to his sister: "Follow him." So she watched himfrom afar place (secretly), while they perceived not.} 412. And We had already forbidden foster suckling mothers for him, until she said : "Shall 1 direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?"} 413. So We restored him to his mother, that her eye might be comforted, and that she might not grieve, and that she might know that the promise ofAllah is true. But most of them know not.}

found in their household, and he did not accept any of them, refusing to take milk from them. So they took him out to the marketplace, hoping to find a woman who would be suitable to nurse him. When (his sister) saw him in their arms, she recognized him, but she did not give any indication nor did they suspect her. Allah says: }AndWehad alreadyforbiddenfoster suckling mothersforhim,} Because of his honored status with Allah, it was forbidden by divine decree. It was decreed that no one should nurse him except his own mother, and Allah caused this to be the means reuniting him with his mother so that she could nurse him and feel safe after having) felt such fear. When [his sister] saw that they were confused over who should nurse the child, ^j *) cj; jit jjc ishe said: "Shall I direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?"} Ibn 'Abbas said: When she said that, they had some doubts about her, so they seized her and asked her, How do you know these people will be sincere and will care for him?" She said to them, "They will be sincere and will care for him because they want the king to be happy and because they hope for some reward." So they let her go. After what she said, being safe from their harm, they took her to their house and brought the baby to his mother. She gave him her breast and he accepted it, so they rejoiced and sent the glad tidings to the wife of Fir'awn. She called for Musa's mother, treating her kindly and rewarding her generously. She did not realize that she was his real mother, but she saw that the baby accepted her breast. Then Asiyah asked her to stay with her and nurse the baby, but she refused, saying, "I have a husband and children, and I cannot stay with you, but ifyou would like me to nurse him in my own home, I will do that." The wife of Fir'awn agreed to that, and paid her a regular salary and gave her extra gifts and clothing and treated her kindly. The mother ofMusa came back with her child, happy that after a time of fear Allah granted her security, prestige, and ongoing provision. There was only a short time between the distress and the

way out, a day and night, or thereabouts - and Allah knows best. Glory be to the One in Whose hands are all things; what He wills happens and what He does not will does not happen. He is the One Who grants those who fear Him, a way out from every worry and distress, Allah said: '\$ S 4^ iSo We restored him to his mother, that her eye might be comforted, means, by him, %} iand that she might not grieve, means, for if 'X%>} iand that she might know that the promise ofAllah is true.} meaning, "We had promised her to return him to her and to make him one of the Messengers.' When he was returned to

her, she realized that he was one of the Messengers, so as she brought him up, she treated him both as a child (with kindness) and as a Messenger (with respect). {But most of them know not.} means, they do not know the wisdom of Allah in His actions and their good consequences, for which He is to be praised in this world and the Hereafter. For a thing may happen that people do not like, but its consequences

386 Tafstr Ibn KathTr iAnd thus do We reward the doers ofgood.} Then Allah describes how MQsa reached the status that was decreed for him, that of Prophethood and speaking to Allah, as a direct consequence of killing the Coptic, which was the reason why he left Egypt and went to Madyan. Allah says: Ik f-Lc. Jc ilojf &-*j} iAnd he entered the city when its people were unaware.} Ibn Jurayj narrated from ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, from Ibn ‘Abbas, “That was between Maghrib and ‘/sftd”¹¹ ‘ Ibn Al-Munkadir narrated from ‘Ata’ bin Yasar from Ibn ‘Abbas, “That was in the middle of the day.”¹²¹ This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, As-SuddI and Qatadah. Ijj iand he found there two men fighting,} meaning, hitting one another and struggling with one another. ione ofhis party,} meaning, an Israelite, iand the other of his foes.} meaning, a Coptic . This was the view of Ibn ‘Abbas, Qatadah, As-SuddI and Muhammad bin Ishaq . ¹⁴¹ The Israelite man asked Musa, peace be upon him, for help, and Musa took advantage of the fact that people were not paying attention, so he went to the Coptic man and i*\$ fui fry fj\$} iso Musa struck him with his fist and he died.} Mujahid said, “This means he punched him with his fist.”¹⁵¹ At-Tabari 19:538. At-Tabari 19:538. At-Tabari 19:539. At-Tabari 19:539, 540. |5J At-Tabari 19:540.

in You and go against Your commands.' ** .1? til'. 1*7' *1 vili] /U jw <3 Qe*'''? j! j JLi Lf) _>-Xc jh l\$Jt ji Uii uj L>J j I j oj_ ciii 418. So he became afraid, looking about in the city, when behold, the man who had sought his help the day before, called for his help (again). Musa said to him : "Verily, you are a plain misleader!"} 419. Then when he decided to seize the man who was an enemy to both of them, the man said: "O Musa! Is it your intention to kill me as you killed a man yesterday? Your aim is nothing but to become a tyrant in the land, and not to be one of those who do right."}

How the Secret of this Killing became known

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4253–4322]

Allah tells us that when Musa killed that Coptic, 4^jE- 4^

he became afraid in the city meaning, of the consequences of his action, i looking about> means, turning around and watching out, waiting for the consequences of his action to befall him. He went out and about, and saw the man who sought his help the day before, fighting with another Coptic. When Musa passed by him, he called for his help again, against this other Coptic. Musa said to him: 4<iif iVerily, you are a plain misleader!} meaning, "you obviously lead people astray and are veiy evil.' Then Musa intended to attack that Coptic, but the Israelite — because of his own cowardice and weakness - thought that Musa wanted to hit him because of what he had said, so he said, in self-defence - 4° Musa! Is it your intention to kill me as you killed a man yesterday?} Nobody except him and Musa, peace be upon him, knew about it, but when the other Coptic heard this, he took the news to Fir'awn's gate and told him about it. So Fir'awn came to know of it, and he became very angry and resolved to kill Musa, so he sent people after him to bring him to him. JiJIL JL <r\ 2^ ju £> CSt £ 3w o; ctU 420. And there came a man running, from the farthest end of the city. He said: "O Miisa! Verily, the chiefs are taking counsel together about you, to kill you, so escape. Truly, I am one of the good advisers to you ." \$> 4And there came a man} He is described as being a man because he had the courage to take a different route, a shorter route than those who were sent after Musa, so he reached Musa first and said to him: "O Musa, 4^i4^ S*4i'

si usqjvfuno puy •(syootfump) xpr} spusqdaqs dip \pun (siporf uno) udfvoi ;ouum a/vi,, :pws Rdqi „inofi ipim uopvtu sip si miM,, : P!VS dH '(@po]fump) ypvq Euidodq 3U3<n oqoi udiuooi oaij punof 3i{ tU3W sopisoq puv 'Sutuoijvm udui fo dnouE v 3U3ip puncf 3i{ 'uvRpvq fo U3)vai dip }v psauuo at/ uai/m puy £Z\$ 4,,fivai p 8u dip o; diu sopinS puoq Riu }mp dq fvtu if,, :pws at/ 'uvfipvyq spuow/ }U3oi di{ udqoi puy zib 4"jSJdop8uoum 3uv oqai ojdoos dip utojf diu daog jp-to7 Ryq,, :pivs af/ uvdffo 3}V}S v ui ptoqv Sup/00/ 'duoip tuoif podooso dq og izb & irq g?X if h *rC -\$ jr*T ii^v flfp rf? #2* ?C n 752P fT-i^r a? cfrf-J "" f^ /•// c ^ 'T' irt tC?"> p/ " 3? 5 a?^ <TT' ,f> ?f-f# J- >• y ^tr :m; 10 ?r ^ P to 3 »r - 4'uo/i 07 sudsiapv poo8 dip fo duo uiv 1 'Rpui\$ «r rtf' rf? ST ^P >r itjf »nr/** 1} //} <* / » # / pirej stip uiojj 'stream i'3dv3S3 OS 'nofl UPi 0/\$> nOIC jnoqB jaipoire auo qiiM Suiqnsuoo 3jb jCaqj, 'SuiuBsm „^noR jtioqv uoipoEo} idsunod EupjV) duv sfdiip dip 'R\udj\$ fin* ? <*=4rfRH !!•<*<' 1* ^^ //// / /// ^ 11^7 r=^==r^gtln^ttrirr^Pif\irf ?r\p up^r\$frplTs!!rr^fr:5p^'^ rn^Tn^ vva 6>e (oz-m) in - o?; svsvq-iv -szwvs

a very old man."} 424. So he watered (theirflocks) for them, then he turned back to shade, and said: "My Lord! Truly, I am in need of whatever good that You bestow on me!"} Musa, peace be upon him, in Madyan, and how He watered the Flocks of the Two Women When the man told Musa about how Fir'awn and his chiefs were conspiring against him, he left Egypt on his own. He was not used to being alone, because before that he had been living a life of luxury and ease, in a position of leadership. iSo he escaped from there, looking about in a state of fear.} meaning, turning around and watching. iMy Lord! Save me from the people who are wrongdoers!} means, from Fir'awn and his chiefs. It was mentioned that Allah sent to him an angel riding a horse, who showed him the way. And Allah knows best. «LiC &j} iAnd when he went towards (the land of) Madyan,} means, he took a smooth and easy route - and he rejoiced because of that. 'Ay isi-i-a u' ihe said: "It may be that my Lord guides me to the right way."} meaning, the most straight route. And Allah did indeed do that, for He guided him to the straight path in this world and the Hereafter, and caused him to be guided and to guide others. i&z &£ cjj} iAnd when he arrived at the water (a well) of Madyan,} means, when he reached Madyan and went to drink from its water, for it had a well where shepherds used to water their flocks.

voir^ iit ot!0\ Ail '^j) ihe found there a group of men watering, and besides them he found two women who were keeping back.) means, they were stopping their sheep from drinking with the sheep of those shepherds, lest some harm come to them. When Musa, peace be upon him, saw them, he felt sorry for them and took pity on them. 4He said: "What is the matter with you?"} meaning, "why do you not water your flocks with these people?" &£) iThey said: "We cannot water until the shepherds take..."} meaning, *we cannot water our flocks until they finish.' 4And our father is a very old man.) means, 'this is what has driven us to what you see.' iSo he watered (theirflocks) for them,) ii Ji*- ot !|, LJ (jl. VJ J'-** lii iv ^>))then he turned back to shade, and said : "My Lord! Truly, I am in need of whatever good that You bestow on me!") 4j4>' «5l> ito shade,) Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and As-Suddi said: "He sat beneath a tree."111 'Ata' bin As-Sa'ib said: "When MUsa said: yV- Ct Q.)"My Lord! Truly, I am in need of whatever good that You bestow on me!") the women heard him."121 111 At-Tabari 19:556. 121 At-Tabari 19:557.

392 Tafsir Von Kathlr t3 C j;i c>1 <£>J. iJli ,>^ &3> iJU J#^< j jl jXaji JJJ ll£ ^ -iy' 4l >JB \SUS\$ <4^ _£. <£.i £i>Xi ->-u- c— <\$ g*e- ijfo J£ 0l» tSj^l & x % 'te. 4 ci^: <£t£ Jit ^ lyl t; 4\$)2U-j 4£ G& 5&SS <£&£ 5B jJivf i3 Xi-rj 425. Thai there came to him one of them, walking shyly. She said : Verily, my father calls you that he may reward you for turning watered (our flocks) for us." So when he came to him and narrated the story, he said: "Fear ydu not. You have escaped from the people who are wrongdoers."} 426. And said one of them (the two women): "O my father! Hire him! Verily, the best of men for you to hire is the strong, the trustworthy."} He said : I intend to wed one of these two daughters of mine to you, on condition that you serve me for eight years but if you complete ten years, it will be (a favor) from you. But I intend not to place you under a difficulty. If Allah wills, you will find me one of the righteous."} 42S. He (Musa) said: "That (is settled) between me and you: whichever of the two terms I fulfill, there will be no injustice to me, and Allah is Surety over what we say."} Musa, the Father of the Two Women, and His Marriage to One of Them When the two women came back quickly with the sheep, then- father was surprised that they returned so soon. He asked them what had happened, and they told him what Musa, peace be upon him, had done. So he sent one of them to nail

him to meet her father. Allah says: {Then there came to him one of them, walking shyly.} meaning, she was walking like a free woman, as it was narrated from the Commander of the faithful, 'Umar, may

393 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (25 - 28) (Part-20) Allah be pleased with him: "She was covering herself from them with the folds of her garment." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Amr bin Maymun said, 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "She came walking shyly, putting her garment over her face. She was not one of those audacious women who come and go as they please."12 ' This chain of narrators is Sahih. {She said: "Verily, my father calls you that he may reward you for having watered (our flocks) for us."} This is an example of good manners: she did not invite him directly lest he have some suspicious thoughts about her. Rather she said: "My father is inviting you so that he may reward you for watering our sheep," i.e., give you some payment for that. { } So when he came to him and narrated the story, { means, he told him about his story and why he had to leave his country. {Os-hlajt ihe said: "Fear you not. You have escaped from the people who are wrongdoers."} He was saying: 'calm down and relax, for you have left their kingdom and they have no authority in our land.' So he said: { } You have escaped from the people who are wrongdoers. { } And said one of them : "O my father! Hire him! Verily, the best of men for you to hire is the strong, the trustworthy."} One of the two daughters of the man said this, and it was said that she was the one who had walked behind Musa, peace be upon him. She said to her father: 111 At-Tabari 19:558. (2) AMabari 19:559.

any inconvenience or argue with you.' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Ali bin Rabah Al-Lakhmi said, "I heard Tjbah bin An-Nadar As-Sulami, the Companion of the Messenger of Allah jg narrating that the Messenger of Allah jg said: uj® ^Musa, peace be upon him, hired himself out for the purpose of keeping chaste and to feed himself. »,1) And Allah tells us o>> b about i Musa, peace > yj purti 4He said: "That (is settled) between me and you: whichever of the two terms I fulfill, there will be no injustice to me, and Allah is Surety over what we say."} Musa said to his father-in-law, "The matter is as you say. You have hired me for eight years, and if I complete ten years, that is my choice, but if I do the lesser amount, I will still have fulfilled the covenant and met the conditions." So he said: ^ cJiVf0} 4whichever of the two terms I fulfill, there will be no injustice to me,} meaning, there will be no blame on me. The complete term is permissible but it is still regarded as something extra.' This is like the Ayah, 4But whosoever hastens 'to leave in two days, there is no sin on him and whosoever stays on, there is no sin on him} (2:203). And the Messenger of Allah said to Hamzah bin 'Amr Al- Aslami, may Allah be pleased with him, who used to fast a great deal and who asked him about fasting while traveling: I1 ' Al-Bazz&r 1495. This Hadxth has two different chains of narration. That of Al-Bazz&r is very weak , that of Ibn Abi Hatim has a minor deficiency and is also technically weak. Some HadUh scholars would consider it a valid witness.

ogam mm If ip <.'feas jLi <, ^ «Mj(i juSbL^f w7 --^r-r . «.f / - f^.? - : alf y°u wish > then fist. and if you wish, do not > '>'AC\ ">^r even though it is better to ^st, 0 according to the /{4.,/{ / ..j ^ / .> evidence of other reports. And there is «aSS»2JUjijytt(S)<£«-?(&• f v 'denct which s ,s '* > •' indlcates that Musa, peace be upon him, the two terms. jti^<^A*yli£y Al-Bukhari recorded ol that Sa,d bin Jubayr said: "A Jew from the §pOi>uS3t^cjWtjJjj3i*ulo people of Hlrah asked ^4diiaj^iuiiik£jis "i ;J,, hic h."f*e TM° u w terms did Musa fumn? 1 said > 'f do" " " " ~ l[not untii i g0 to the scholar of the Arabs and ask him.' So I went to Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and asked him. He

said: *He fulfilled the longer and better of them, for when a Messenger of Allah said he would do a thing, he did it.’” This is how it was recorded by Al-Bukhari.¹²¹ u| L>tj _y£l' ijiL ir_)Ly jJil llli^ UJi 'P& J3\ sdik }j±& j\ fk (4^ fee -p <ji dk\ : ^ ^1 &o*-i O', tj Lrtfi j'ji'” ^IS}y 1+^3 v-4-*. 1 Jb jj it- iv lilij dli jJL^c. jji ut> 4-u [1 > Al-Bukhari no. 1943. 121 See volume six, the Tafsirof Sarah faHa (20:11-16).

jf. *Uj- gy* j i-li* Vj Jyljilj 429. Then, when Musa had fulfilled the term, and was traveling with his family, he saw a fire in the direction of At- Tur. He said to hisfamily : "Wait, I have seen a fire; perhaps I may bring to you from there some information, or a burning firebrand that you may warm yourselves."} 430. So when he reached it, he was calledfrom the right side of the valley, in the blessed place, from the tree: "O Musa! Verily, I am Allah, the Lord ofall that exists!"} i31 . "And throw your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and looked not back. (It was said:) "O Musa! Draw near, andfear not. Verily, you are of those who are secure."} 432. "Put your hand into the opening ofyour garment, it will come forth white without a disease; and draw your hand close to your side to befreefrom the fear. These are two proofsfrom your Lord to Fir'awn and his chiefs. Verily, they are the people who are rebellious."} Musa's Return to Egypt and how he was honored with the Mission and Miracles on theWay In the explanation of the previous Ayah, we have already seen that MQsa completed the longer and better of the two terms, whichmay also be understood from theAyahwhere Allah says: &} 4Then, when Musa hadfulfilled the term,} meaning, the longer of the two; and Allah knows best. \ J^j} iand was traveling with his family,} They said: "MQsa missed his country and his relatives, so he resolved to visit them in secret, without Fir'awn and his people knowing. So he gathered up his family and the flocks which his father-in-law had given to him, and set out on a cold, dark, rainy night. They stopped to camp,

meaning, "the One Who is addressing you and speaking to you is the Lord of all that exits, the One Who does what He wills, the One apart from Whom there is no other god or lord, may He be exalted and sanctified, the One Who by His very nature, attributes, words and deeds is far above any resemblance to His creation, may He be glorified. \$ &} }And throw your stick!} 'the stick that is in your hand' - as was stated in the Ayah, 4"And what is that in your right hand, O Musa?" He said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean, and wherewith I beat down branches for my sheep, and wherein I find other uses."} (20 :17-18). The meaning is: This stick, which you know so well;' 4"Cast it down, O Musa!" He cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} (20:19-20). Musa knew that the One Who was speaking to him was the One Who merely says to a thing, "Be!" and it is, as we have already stated in (the explanation of) Surah Ta Ha. And here Allah says: 4<jfo£%&& }But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight,} It moved so quickly, even though it was so big, and its mouth was so huge, with its jaws snapping. It swallowed every rock it passed, and every rock that fell into its mouth fell with a sound like a rock falling into a valley. When he saw that: }he turned in flight, and looked not back.} he did not turn around. 111 FathAl-Bari 5 :342 .

4to Fir'awn and his chiefs .^ meaning his leaders and prominent followers. iVerily, they are the people who are rebellious .} means, who are disobedient towards Allah and who go against His commands and His religion. ^ c? «U£i Oj JI5^ iiU.1 -iljulac JC.» Jtt J uiU-i Cfedf C23 SJL-S :*&& i2j 433. He said: "My Lord! I have killed a man among them, and Ifear that they will kill me."4 434. "And my brother Hdrun - he is more eloquent in speech than me, so send him with me as a helper to confirm me. Verily,

Ifear that they will deny me."} 435. Allah said: "We will strengthen your arm through your brother, and give you both power, so they shall not be able to harm you, with Our Aydt; you two as well as those whofollow you, will be the victors."} HowMusaasked for the Support ofHis Brotherandwas granted thatby Allah When Allah commanded him to go to Fir'awn, the one who he had run away from and whose vengeance he feared, tiii <j[4l> j&} 4 Musa said: My Lord! I have killed a man among them,} meaning, that Coptic, 4and Ifear that they will kill me.} i.e., "when they see me.' 4And my brother Harun - he is more eloquent in speech than me,} Musa, peace be upon him, had a speech defect, because when

iYou are granted your request, O Musa!} (20:36) iAnd We granted him his brother Harun, (also) a Prophet, out ofOur mercy} (19:53). One of the Salaf said, "There is no one who has ever done a greater favor to his brother than Musa did for Harun, may peace be upon them both, for he interceded for him until Allah made him a Prophet and Messenger with him to Fir'awn and his chiefs. Allah said concerning Mdsa: \$ ig&} ihe was honorable before Allah} (33:69). l&J &&} iand (We will) give you both power} means, overwhelming evidence. iso they shall not be able to harm you, with Our Aydt;} means, they will have no way or means of harming you because you are conveying the signs of Allah.' This is like the Aydt ikl * 4 t j£ <&} iO Messenger! Proclaim (the Message) which has been sent down to youfrom your Lord.} until His saying: i'J* u iAllah will protect youfrom mankind} (5:67). * t iThose who convey the Message ofAllah} until His saying: \$>} iAnd sufficient is Allah as a Reckoner} (33:39). And sufficient is Allah as a Helper and Supporter. And Allah

404 TafsTr Ibn Kathir told them the consequences in this world and the next, for them and for those who followed them, HS0 <&\$& iyou two as well as those who follow you will be the victors.} This is like the Ayat. 0 i3 &=>} Si» iAllah has decreed "Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, All-Mighty.} (58:21) <eiif igu 4 4Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life (40:51) to the end of the Ayah. rJ} HjSksm w gssngu ^)l-XllbU\fli .X) c.U.I "lift •r y?<" '>\A- ' ' " A*' 4 04, C>C uj ui C i 4^* jO 6^3 ,j^ .»J-^ 4; c^i+H; ,>j pit Isry-S' — JU> <(36. Then when Musa came to than with Our Clear Ayat, they said: "This is nothing but invented magic. Neva did we hear of this among ourfathers ofold."} 437. Musa said: "My Lord knows best him who came with guidance from Him, and whose will be the happy end in the Haeafter. Verily, the wrongdoers will not be successful."}

405Surah 28. Al-Oasas (36 - 37) (Part-20) Musa before Fir'awn and His People Allah tells us how Musa and his brother HarQn came before Fir'awn and his chiefs, and showed them the clear miracles and overwhelming proof that Allah had given them to confirm the truth ofwhat they were saying about Allah being One and that His commandments were to be followed. Fir'awn and his chiefs saw that with their own eyes and realized that it was certainly from Allah, but because of their disbelief and sin they resorted to stubbornness and false arguments. This was because they were too evil and arrogant to follow the truth. They said: iThis is nothing but invented magic meaning, fabricated and made up. They wanted to oppose him by means of their own tricks and their position and power, but this did not work. e&c xi cj} iNever did we hear of this among ourfathers ofold.} They were referring worshipping Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. They said: "We have never seen anyone among our forefathers following this religion; we have only ever seen people associating other gods in worship with Allah.

MUSA said in response to them: 4*2:J-5 O' jjet 4My Lord knows best him who came with guidance from Him,} meaning, 'of me and you, and He will decide between me and you.' So he said: ijti w IP&} iand whose will be the happy end in the Hereafter.} meaning, who will be supported and will prevail. 4Verily, the wrongdoers will not be successful.} refers to the idolaters who associate others in worship with Allah.

js sj > S/fi Al J* (• Sul' S&j) j* A-A) -iSi (*liiV jjj ^_yy aJi d] Mi*' J J;Mti Y4±J V Ml EiJ 4^i>^ csiVf ? >Prj iijl jjU lil' M-6 Mi^=> >-i^ jLk>l» .iM ci jnftJM py A'^ji] UjII aJJ-> j |>4 i<;*^j ,av, ij_}^»aj V iLiili jdll cil ^jyy^> 4l^C(ja5^» ,vi 433. Fir'awn said: "O chiefs/ I /cnou> no/ that you have a god other than me. So kindle for me (a fire), O Human, to bake clay, and set up for me a Sarh in order that I may look at the God ofMusa; and verily, I think that he (Musa) is one of the liars.") <439. And he and his armies were arrogant in the land, without right, and they thought that they would never return to Us.) 440. So, We seized him and his artnies, and We threw them all into the sea. So, behold what was the end of the wrongdoers.) 441. And We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day ofResurrection, they will not be helped.) 442. And We made a curse to follow them in this world, and on the Day ofResurrection, they will be among disgraced.) The Arrogance ofFir'awn and His ultimate Destiny Allah tells us of Fir'awn's disbeliefand wrongdoing, and how he falsely claimed divinity for his evil self, may Allah curse him. /tiji 4Thus hefooled his people, and they obeyed him.) [43:54] He called on his people to recognize his divinity, and they responded, because oftheirweak and foolish minds. So, he said: 4^sJ> SuK tffe) 40 chiefs! I know not that you have a god other than me.) Allah tells us about Fir'awn:

4Then he gathered (his people) and cried aloud, saying : "I am your lord, most high." So Allah, seized him with punishment for his last and first transgression. Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for whosoeverfears Allah.} (79:23-26) meaning: he brought his people together and called to them in a loud voice, shouting that, and they responded to him obediently. So Allah took revenge on him, and made him a lesson to others in this world and the Hereafter. He even confronted Musa with that, and said: JI Lft till) 4If you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners} (26:29). j}l cr^4ri «4 4So kindle for me (a fire), O Hdmdn, to bake (bricks out of) clay, and set up for me a Sarh in order that I may look at the God ofMusa;} He commanded his minister and adviser Haman to bake bricks for him, i.e., to make bricks in order to build a Sarh, a exalted towering palace. This is like the Ayah, j}l J Oj7j> JBj^ »jk oy-yA Cff ts"J» 4 vi }And Fir'awn said: "O HSman! Build me a Sarh that I may arrive at the ways - the ways of the heavens, and I may look upon the God of Musa, but verily, I think him to be a liar." Thus it was made fair seeming, in Fir'awn's eyes, the evil of his deeds, and he was hindered from the path; and the plot of Fir'awn led to nothing but loss and destruction} (40:36-37). Fir'awn built this tower, which was the highest structure ever seen on earth, because he wanted to show his people that MOsA was lying when he claimed that there was a God other than Fir'awn. Fir'awn said: iUgs&£»&} iand verily, I think that he (Musa) is one of the liars.}

meaning, 'when he says that there is a lord other than me.' The issue was not whether Allah had sent Mtisa, because he did not acknowledge the existence of the Creator in the first place. On the contrary, he said: is £>} 4And what is the Lord ofAl-'Alamin?} (26:23) and: 4'okfy^ Si ojJlf g\$} 4tf you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners.} (26:29) and he said: 4^ .4*^ssjxc yai \

\$k} 40 chiefs! I know not that you have a god other than me.} This was the view of Ibn Jarir. 11 ' v £-4i jfjti ji 4And he and his armies were arrogant in the land, without right, and they thought that they would never return to Us.} means, they were arrogant oppressors who spread much mischief in the land, and they believed that there would be no Resurrection. 3f> \ ly ilifj Z~aji} 4So, your Lord poured on them different kinds of severe torment. Verily, your Lord is Ever Watchful (over them).} (89:13-14). Allah says here: 4i\$ 4 &&&} 4So, We seized him and his armies, and We threw them all into the sea.} meaning, *We drowned them in the sea in a single morning, and not one of them was left.' 4^ \ J -£-S>I£=» 4So, behold what was the end of the wrongdoers. And We m At-Tabari 19 :580

409Surah 28. Al-Oasas (42 - 43) (Part-20) made them leaders inviting to the Fire) for those who followed them and took the same path as they did, rejecting the Messengers and denying the Creator. idjjCa* V iand on the Day ofResurrection, they will not be helped. their humiliation in this world is combined with and connected to their humiliation in the Hereafter, as Allah says: 4We have destroyed them. And there was none to help them (47:13). iAnd We made a curse to follow them in this world,) Allah decreed that they and their king Fir'awn should be cursed by the believers among His servants who follow His Messengers, just as in this world they were cursed by the Prophets and their followers. (*-* fyj) iand on the Day of Resurrection, they will be among disgraced.) Qatadah said, "This Ayah is like the Ayah, ii-ii j iThey were pursued by a curse in this (life) and on the Day of Resurrection. Evil indeed is the gift given.) (ingg)."11 ! jkzZai 4/i'l 443. And indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember.) |i| At-Tabari 19:583.

The Blessingswhich AllahbestoweduponMusa Allah tells us about the blessings which He gave His servant and Messenger Musa, the speaker, may the best of peace and blessings • from his Lord be upon him, He revealed the Tawrah to him after He destroyed Fir'awn and his chiefs. gad zm iafier VJe had destroyed the generations ofold After the revelation of the Tawrah, no nation would again be punished with an overwhelming calamity; instead the believers were now commanded to fight the enemies of Allah among the idolators, as Allah says: Js ysgtm rw mm ^-=»LSCj s } /// „ O „ } "*"r> ojj j— >< \ ". 1»-"C*>A" s' * -Y4.i ^ vV:' |»fJ Jj"V !>*" izJZfjjJlj |>>J i>J^» iAnd Fir'own, and those before him, and the cities overthrown committed sin. And they disobeyed their Lord's Messenger, so He seized them with a strong punishment} (69:9-10). tf-Uy j.^£u} ias an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy,} guidance from blindness and error. A guidance to the truth and a mercymeans, to show the way towards doing righteous deeds.

\$*} ithat they might remember.} means, that the people might be reminded and guided by it. • X / V ,// •< O?jS di VrSjit ij i^jdl cX Cj} jjLU LCjII jl jj.Uli cX CJ ; J VJ (*+U Cj4 jXl £ j*4-^ 4& Z4{ ZZ.} V M . A .s v. t, A*J | W iCM> i44. And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment, and you were not among the witnesses.} 445. But We created generations, and long were the ages that passed over them. And you were not a dweller among the people of Madyan, reciting Our Ayat to them. But it is We Who kept sending (Messengers).} 446. And you were not at the side ofAt-Tur when We called. But (you are sent) as a mercyfrom your Lord, to give warning to a people to whom no wamer had come before you, in order that they may remember or receive admonition.} 447. And if(We had) not (sent you to the people ofMakkah) in case a calamity

should seize them for what their hands have sent forth, they would have said: "Our Lord! Why did You not send us a Messenger? We would then have followed Your Ayat and would have been among the believers."} Proof of the Prophethood of Muhammad^ Allah points out the proof of the prophethood of Muhammad whereby he told others about matters of the past, and spoke about them as if he were hearing and seeing them for himself. But he was an illiterate man who could not read books, and he grew up among a people who knew nothing of such things. Similarly, Allah told him about Maryam and her story, as Allah said:

i) 63 4You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens as to which of them should be charged with the care of Maryam; nor were you with them when they disputed (3:44), meaning, "you were not present then, but Allah has revealed this to you." Similarly, Allah told him about Nuh and his people, and how He saved Nuh and drowned his people, then He said: \ iA ^ cS U JU) 'r^ tiJ Ji iThis is of the news of the Unseen which We reveal unto you ; neither you nor your people knew it before this. So, be patient. Surely, the (good) end is for those who have Taqwa (11:49). And at the end of the same Surah (Hud) Allah says: iThat is some of the news of the towns which We relate unto you^ (11:100). And here, after telling the story of Musa from beginning to end and how Allah began His revelation to him and spoke with him, Allah says: 4jIS/ ' ts'f d) i) ^ <\$.And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment, meaning, "you - O Muhammad - were not on the western side of the mountain where Allah spoke to Musa from the tree which was to the east of it, in the valley." iand you were not among the witnesses.} *to that event, but Allah has revealed this to you,' so that it may be evidence and proof of events which happened centuries ago, for people have forgotten the evidence that Allah established against them and what was revealed to the earlier Prophets.

—I —> ^j} you were not a dweller among the people of Madyan, reciting Our Ayat to them.} meaning, "you were not living among the people of Madyan reciting Our Ayat to them, when you started to tell about Our Prophet Shu'ayb and what he said to his people and how they responded.' 4But it is We Who kept sending .} means, "but We revealed that to you and sent you to mankind as a Messenger.' 4&X it cX Cj} 4And you were not at the side of At-Tur when We called.} Qatadah said that: 4&X >.! JjX cX Cj} 4And you were not at the side of At-Tfir when We did call.} refers to Musa, and this - and Allah knows best - is like the Ayah 4 \dXt ij L^jt ijiii cX Cj} 4And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment,} Here Allah puts it in a different and more specific way by describing it as a call. This is like the Ayat i&S& iS& if)} 4And (remember) when your Lord called Musa} (26:10). ^ aljil fj j it i(^ iWheti his Lord called him in the sacred valley of Tuwa} (79:16). jjX '-X& 4And We called him from the right side of At-Tur, and made him draw near to Us for a talk with him} (19:52). o* &ij}

415 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (48 - 51) (Part-20 rst ifi'fr J^Sl' I'.i tgSHEii ^ Messengers^ (4:165). 4^—jJL(jji >iiti^& ;db^ ••*' '< /// />''' V/- ^ '''^ ^ /> / • jjylij^ L »Cj(>•15 Jjl iil*4(Isjlli *jj GjJ<j*t5^ j£oy»j4l) fyfrj*o^V.^-s^Lfe!j^Sj ^ N^ij^LoV|tAj^=3\ fr'C 1 v-i?31 •1 i-'V " -''' -t' *Vi <" 4-31 ' Oi /a* cf (£-> <^ri yi£ ^ fit C ij5ys AjJ&j J^rt f&r •& 40 People of the Scriphire! Now has come to you Our Messenger making (things) clear unto you, after a break in (the series of) Messengers, lest you say: "There came unto us no bringer of glad tidings and no warner." But now has come unto you a bringer of glad tidings and a Warner^ (5:19). And there are many similar Ayat. * &t jtt&s- J4 1>2 tsrf |Ujt fyy £^jj\

H jZa Hf jllli Lx £f* tfj.jS <J>t X^ 0* j* £) 'JlSj Ir-fi jJ c^j j&ti <AJJ j/. *; ,. ' . jj 'A'^ixX, J^£=> u) <*3 uii; j53j £it^ 'J at <<,) 'at^ ^ gt^4#^: ^ jj3t fi 448. Bid when the truth has come to than from Us, they say: "Why is he not given the like of what was given to Musa? Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old?" They say : "Two kinds of magic, each helping the other!" And they say: "Verily, in both we are disbelievers." 449. Say: "Then bring a Book from Allah, which is a better

guide than these two, that I may follow it, if you are truthful."} 450. But if they answer you not, then know that they only follow their own lusts. And who is more astray than one who follows his own lusts, without guidance from Allah? Verily, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers. 451 . And indeed now We have conveyed the Word to them, in order that they may remember. The stubborn Response of the Disbelievers Allah tells us that if people were to be punished before proof was established against them, they would use the excuse that no Messenger came to them, but when the truth did come to them through Muhammad jfe, in their stubbornness, disbelief, ignorance and misguided thinking, they said: 4Why is he not given the like of what was given to Musa?} Meaning - and Allah knows best - many signs like the staff, the hand, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs, the blood, the destruction of crops and fruits - which made things difficult for the enemies of Allah - and the parting of the sea, the clouds (following the Children of Israel in the wilderness and) shading them, the manna and quails, and other clear signs and definitive proof, miracles which Allah wrought at the hands of Musa as evidence and proof against Fir'awn and his chiefs and the Children of Israel. But all of this had no effect on Fir'awn and his chiefs; on the contrary, they denied Musa and his brother HarUn, as Allah tells us: 45&& 4\$ 4 & ojs; im:& ZZ-j&&& 4Have you come to us to turn us away from what we found our fathers following, and that you two may have greatness in the land? We are not going to believe you two!} (10:78) 4So they denied them both and became of those who were destroyed.} (23:48)

417Surah 28. Al-Oasas (48 - 51) (Part-20) The Rebellious do not believe in Miracles Allah says here: 0i i 4Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old?) Did not mankind disbelieve in those mighty signs which were given to Musa? Ab-4^" o!r*-.? AThey say: "Two kinds of magic, each helping the other!") cooperating or working one with the other. 4And they say: "Verily, in both we are disbelievers.") meaning, "we disbelieve in each of them.' Because of the close relationship between Musa and Hariin, mention of one includes the other. False Accusation that Musa and Hariin (peace be upon them both) practiced Magic Mujahid bin Jabr said, "The Jews told Quraysh to say this to Muhammad then Allah said: 'Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old? They say: Two kinds of magic, each helping the other!' This refers to MQsa and Hariin, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon them both, i'S+ik) ieach helping the other) i.e., working together and supporting one another."111 This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr and Abu Razm that the phrase "two kinds of magic" referred to Musa and Hariin. 121 This is a good suggestion. And Allah knows best. The Response to this False Accusation A'Si&t o!^) At-Tabari 19:588. 121 At-Tabari. 19:598.

down to His Prophets, there is no Book more perfect, more eloquent or more noble than the Book which He revealed to Muhammad jg, which is the Qur'an. Next to it in status and greatness is the Book which Allah revealed to Musa bin Imran, which is the Book concerning which Allah says: 'jjU uOJJ Ij. "jj jja LJj (3yl 4'Ajj£& #Jf j. c iVerily, We did send down the Tawrdh, therein was guidance and light,

by which the Prophets, who submitted themselves to Allah's will, judged for the Jews. And the rabbis and the priests, for to them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they were witnesses thereto (5:44). The Injil was revealed as a continuation and complement of the Tawrah and to permit some of the things that had been forbidden to the Children of Israel. Allah says: 4 Sia £ fix*£UJC \$ iThen bring a Book from Allah, which is a better guide than these two, that 1 may follow it, if you are truthful. meaning, 'in your efforts to refute the truth with false arguments.' 4But if they answer you not,} means, *if they do not respond to what you tell them, and do not follow the truth,' 4then know that they only follow their own lusts.} means, with no basis or evidence. Cj*J7 4And who is more astray than one who follows his own lusts, without guidance from Allah?} means, with no guidance taken from the Book of Allah. fjai <j3k y sif c>l} 4Verily, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.}

4Jj*i' pi ilij jii} 4And indeed now We have conveyed the Word} Mujahid said: "We have explained the Word to them." As- Suddi said something similar. 121 Qatadah said: "Allah is saying, "He has told them what He did in the past and what He will do in the future." i'o iin order that they may remember.} ^ Mujahid and others said: 4We have conveyed the Word means, to Quraysh. j>J' lllC ijlli jfjc. lijj I| pd£s3j pi pi^' •""if : ! >" v* i -•* rf' r-iU uAl/4 j*-^***' 0>>>> yuL-* ^ w Ul Ujj pj t5 ye& ^ ^^ 452. Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it.} 453. And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from Muslims."} 454. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient, and repel evil with good, and spend out of what We have provided for them.} 455. And when they hear evil vain talk, they withdraw from it and say: "To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant."} The Believers among the People of the Book Allah tells us that the pious scholars among the People of the 111 At-Tabari 19:593. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 9:2987. 131 At-Tabari 19:593. At-Tabari 19:594.

421 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (52 - 55) (Part-20) Book believe in the Qur'an, as He says: j*- ^4-y'* C/ji'4 iThose to whom We gave the Book recite it as it should be recited, they are the ones who believe therein (2:121). &4 Vipi& e;A i-j; 4&U» 4And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah (3:199). jyy' 4 Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled."} (17:107-108) ll) tjllS \yS't oi\$S iiji 4And you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say : "We are Christians."} until: 4so write us down among the witnesses} (5:82-83). Said bin Jubayr said, "This was revealed concerning seventy priests who were sent by An-Najashi (ruler of Ethiopia). When they came to the Prophet he recited to them: 4Ya Sin. By the Qur'an, full of wisdom.} (36:1-2) until he completed the Surah. They began to weep, and they embraced Islam. These other Ayat were revealed concerning them:*2 ' See volume one, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah (2:121) for comments on this Ayah. '2 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 9 :2988 . This is a Mursal narration

422 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 'ft &'» (ji'i jit?6 dk dvij^» -* (J> -*C» ^ -jIj o; US* \1[fcj (jr iThose to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it. And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from Muslims."} meaning,

'even before the Qur'an came we were Muslims, i.e., we believed in One God and were sincerely responding to Allah's commands.' & #>' Ojii 4These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient,} means, those who have this characteristic - that they believed in the first Book and then in the second. Allah says: because they are patient,} meaning, in their adherence to the truth, for taking such thing upon oneself is not easy for people. It was reported in the Sahih from the Hadith of 'Amir Ash-Sha'bi from Abu Burdah that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: Mj 'iji (*-' itri Ifr 6 ' tiii J c-jlf J -jj ' J*-j j5)l *rYp «There are three who will be given their reward twice: a man among the People of the Book who believed in his Prophet then believed in me; a slave who fulfills his duty towards Allah and towards his master; and a man who has a slave woman and educates her and teaches her good manners, then he frees her and marries her.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Umamah said: "On the day of the Conquest [of Makkah] I was walking alongside the (i| Fath Al-B&ri 1 :229.

Messenger of Allah jg as he was riding, and he said some very beautiful words, including the following: jjLii y,j Qp U dlpj 0 U dj Jz'y di Ji (d-' j*1 •blip U dlpj 0 U dj di ^ «Whoever among the people of the two Books becomes Muslim, he will have his reward twice, and he has the same rights and duties as we do. Whoever among the idolators becomes Muslim ivill have one reward, and he has the same rights and duties as we do." Allah's saying: 4and repel evil with good,} means, they do not respond to evil in kind, rather they forgive and overlook. iand spend out of what We have provided for them.} meaning, 'from the lawful provision that We have given them, they spend on their families and relatives as they are required to do, and they pay Zakah and give voluntary charity.' Ij%A 'Jj& \J^ 4And when they hear evil vain talk, they withdraw from it} meaning, they do not mix with the people who indulge in such talk, rather they do as Allah says: !v* iv iand if they pass by some evil vain talk, they pass by it with dignity} (25:72). 4and they say: "To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant."} means, if some foolish person speaks to them in a foolish manner and says something to which it does not befit them to Ahmad 5:259.

respond, they turn away from him and do not respond in kind with ugly speech. They never say anything but good words. Allah says of them that they say: && ££1 13} \$To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant.} meaning, "we do not seek the way of the ignorant and we do not like it.' ft% £ '& * *£ V \$ is£- k/>- | E<jy' iSi gi; V ^»A/S,irgPl >v3> SJJ fr, lijj 456. Wri/y, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills. And He knows best those who are the guided.} 457. And they say: "If we follow the guidance with you, we would be snatched away from our land." Have We not established for them a secure sanctuary, to which are brought fruits of all kinds, a provision from Ourselves, but most of them know not.} Allah guides Whom He wills Allah says to His Messenger jg: 'O Muhammad: iVerily, you guide not whom you like}' meaning, The matter does not rest with you; all that you have to do is convey the Message, and Allah will guide whom He wills, and His is the ultimate wisdom,' as He says: «»* i*idt Jj 4Not upon you is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills.} (2:272) cJiTfr jjj \Zj} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) This Ayah is even more specific than the following:

>7< '1J 4Verily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills. And He knows best those who are the guided> meaning: Allah knows best who deserves to be guided and who deserves to

be misguided. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that this Ayah was revealed concerning Abu Talib, the paternal uncle of the Messenger of Allah. He used to protect the Prophet, support him and stand by him. He loved the Prophet jg dearly, but this love was a natural love, i.e., born of kinship, not a love that was born of the fact that he was the Messenger of Allah jgg . When he was on his deathbed, the Messenger of Allah jg called him to Faith and to enter Islam, but the decree overtook him and he remained a follower of disbelief, and Allah's is the complete wisdom. Az-Zuhri said: "Said bin Al-Musayyib narrated to me that his father, Al-Musayyib bin Hazan Al-Makhzumi, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "When Abu Talib was dying, the Messenger of Allah 5*g came to him and found Abu Jahl bin Hisham and 'Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah bin Al-Mughirah with him. The Messenger of Allah jg said: «<iii j4 i* iu' las \ V :ji JU u» «0 my uncle, say La ilaha illalldh, a word which I may use as evidence in your favor before Allah [in the Hereafter] . Abu Jahl bin Hisham and 'Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah said: 'O Abu Talib, will you leave the religion of 'Abdul-Muttalib?' The Messenger of Allah 4s , kept urging him to say La ilaha illalldh, and they kept saying, Will you leave the religion of 'Abdul-Muttalib?' - until, at the very end, he said that he was on the religion of 'Abdul-Muttalib, and he refused to say La ilaha illalldh. The Messenger of Allah said: «aiip Sii U vl ii 4)1 Allah, I shall certainly seek forgiveness for you unless I am told not to. Then Allah revealed:

426 Tafsir Ibn Kathir: It is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the idolaters, even though they be of kin (9:113). And there was revealed concerning Abu Talib the Ayah, if&s; * 3\} 4Verily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills.}" This was recorded (by Al-Bukhari and Muslim) from the Hadith of Az-Zuhri. 11 ' The Excuses made by the People of Makkah for not believing, and the Refutation of Their Excuses 4And they say: "If we follow the guidance with you, we would be snatched away from our land."} Allah tells us that this is the excuse which was given by some of the disbelievers for not following true guidance. They said to the Messenger of Allah jg : w, *r£ isxI' 4If we follow the guidance with you, we would be snatched away from our land.}, meaning, *we are afraid that if we follow the message of guidance that you have brought, and go against the pagan Arab tribes around us, they will seek to do us harm and wage war against us, and they may snatch us away from wherever we may be.' Allah said in response to them: JZs, S p\$} 4Have We not established for them a secure sanctuary,} meaning, the excuse they give is a lie and is false, because Allah has put them in a secure city and a venerated sanctuary which has been safe from the time it was built - how could this sanctuary be safe for them when they believed in disbelief and Shirk, and how could it not be safe for them when they 111 Fath Al-Bori8:365, Muslim 1:54. !*S»

427 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (58 - 59) (Part-20) become Muslims and follow the truth? 4to which are brought fruits of all kinds,} means, all kinds of fruits from the surrounding regions, from At-Ta'if and elsewhere. Similarly, the people of Makkah engaged in trade and other goods also came to their city. & at 4a provision from Ourselves, but most of them know not.} - this is why they said what they said. o; tit \$>} 4fA» vl Jsii- U^=> ^ .tf. 458. And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankless for its means of livelihood! And those are their dwellings, which have not been inhabited after them except a little. And verily, We have been the heirs.} 459. And never will your Lord destroy the towns until He sends to their mother town a Messenger reciting to them Our Ayat. And never would We destroy the towns unless the people thereof are wrongdoers The Destruction of Towns, which are not destroyed until Evidence is established against them Referring to the people of Makkah, Allah says: tii

{&} 4And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankless for its means of livelihood!} They were arrogant transgressors who denied Allah's blessing of giving them ample provision. This is like the Ayah, jS' J* \jjz, 45jj \+JC XL 4And Allah puts forward the example of a township, that dwelt secure and well-content: its provision coming to it in abundance from every place} until:

428 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr 4 > 4So the torment overtook them while they were wrongdoers> (16:112-113) Allah said: 4*i) iAnd those are their dwellings, which have not been inhabited after them except a little. Their land became empty and desolate, and you can see nothing but their dwellings. iAnd verily, We have been the heirs. Their towns became ruins, with none remaining. Then Allah tells us of His justice and that He does not destroy anyone unjustly; on the contrary. He destroys those whom He destroys after establishing proof against them. So, he says: ti '-V. (5)- ii> olf iAnd never will your Lord destroy the towns until He sends to their mother town i.e., Makkah - 4&£ ia Messenger reciting to them Our Ayat> This indicates that the Unlettered Prophet, Muhammad jg was sent from the Mother of Cities as a Messenger to all cities and towns, Arab and non-Arab alike. This is like the Ayat. 4Q£ jij&Si fi iso that you may warn the Mother of Towns and all those around it (6:92). 4dJr fSs*& % <&, ji> iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah (7:158),

429 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (59 - 60) (Part-20) iThat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.) (6:19) Si j&i iZ 4»XJ*y jdS ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.) (11:17). i-ej Cit sy Jj 4And there is not a town but We shall destroy it before the Day of Resurrection, or punish it with a severe torment.) (17:58). Allah tells us that He will destroy every town before the Day of Resurrection, as He says: wssm *p Site Jufyj &&&#{&\$k&32&&£k Jj/ /As. * . • ^ - »J * • a,d&^ >,*> <4 j; r 4And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger.) (17:15). Allah has sent the Unlettered Prophet to all the towns (all of mankind), because he has been sent to the Mother of Cities, their source to which they all return. It was recorded in the Two Sahihis that the Prophet sfe said: fJ-^ J) Ji.: «I have been sent to the red and the black» Muslim 1 :370.

431 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (60-61) (Part-20 is better and more lasting.) (87:16-17). The Messenger of Allah jgg said: ^ as 'i/j iy*3}\ cjJi suaji a «ui *4\y>: tiu «Bi/ Allah, the life of this world in comparison to the Hereafter is as if one of you were to dip his finger in the sea; let him see what comes back to Allah's saying: iHave you then no sense?} means, do those who prefer this world to the Hereafter have no sense? in ."At v '> A 'Y .1 /s" «#*' >T ils he whom We /we promised an excellent promise - which he will find true - like him whom We have made to enjoy the luxuries of the life of the world, then on the Day of Resurrection, he will be among those brought up?} Is the one who believes in the reward which Allah has promised in return for righteous deeds, which he will undoubtedly attain, like one who disbelieves in the meeting with Allah and in His promises and threats? He is only enjoying a few days in this life, in 4then on the Day of Resurrection, he will be among those brought up.} Mujahid and Qatadah said: "He will be among those who are punished." It was said that this was revealed concerning the Messenger of Allah and Abu Jahl, or that it was revealed concerning Hamzah and Ali, and Abu Jahl.'2 * Both views were narrated from Mujahid.^3 ' The apparent meaning is that it is 111 Ahmad 4:230. 121 At-Tabari 19:604, 605. 131 At-Tabari 19:604, 605.

more general than that. This is like the Ayah where Allah describes a believer in Paradise looking out at his companion who is in Hell, and saying: iSj ccSJ jjj '^J^ iHad it not been for the grace of my Lord, I

would certainly have been among those brought forth (to Hell).} (37:57) And Allah says: *but the Jinn know well that they have indeed to appear (before Him)}*(37:158). 462. And (remember) the Day when He will call to them and say: "Where are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?"} 463. Those about whom the Word will have been fulfilled will say: "Our Lord! These are they whom we led astray. We led them astray, as we were astray ourselves. We declare our innocence before You. It was not us they worshipped."} 464. And it will be said: "Call upon your partners," and they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them, and they will see the torment. If only they had been guided!} 465. And the Day He will call to them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers?"} 466. Then the news of a good answer will be obscured to them on that Day, and they will not be able to ask one another.} 467. But as for him who repented, believed, and did righteous deeds, then perhaps he will be among those who are successful.}

The Idolators and Their Partners and the Enmity between Them in the Hereafter Allah informs of how He will rebuke the idolators on the Day of Resurrection, when He will call them and say: 4 "Where are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?"} meaning, 'where are the gods which you used to worship in the world, the idols and rivals? Can they help you or save you?' This is said in the nature of a rebuke and warning, as in the Ayah, *p: & c; %'3py u py3 ;> s.a pr u^ us fi*P ^WP \$ P>* 4 And truly, you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time. You have left behind you all that which We had bestowed on you We see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed to be partners with Allah. Now all relations between you and them have been *ait off*, and all that you used to claim has vanished from you.} (6:94) His saying: *i&i fj££ 2# ft i* Those about whom the Word will have been fulfilled} means the Shayd^{tin} and evil Jinn, and those who used to advocate disbelief. *c tfo ky cr 4* "Our Lord! These are they whom we led astray. We led them astray, as we were astray ourselves. We declare our innocence before You. It was not us they worshipped."} They will testify against them and say that they led them astray, then they will declare their innocence of their worship. This is like the Ayat

434 Tafsir Ibt Kathir *i* And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.) (19:81-82) *u* (*^J 4JJ 3!, jil <i((T/% 5\$ <ca iSjJ <* And who is more astray than one who calls besides Allah, who will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.) (46:5-6). Ibrahim Al-Khalil, peace be upon him, said to his people: *>y_ tj-di 4 (^h-> WjS jrf oj3 Jt JJu*\ £\)* 4 you have taken idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other.) (29:25) *rti * \\r, \id\ sA\ i* When those who were followed disown those who followed, and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut off from them) until: *i* And they will never get out of the Fire.) (2:166-167). Allah says: *. i0&W&)* *i* And it will be said (to them): "Call upon your partners,") meaning, 'to save you from the predicament you are in, as you hoped that they would do in this world.' *<2^ Ifc jfl&S5 i i* and they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them, and they will see the torment.) means, they will realize for sure that they are inevitably destined for the Fire. His saying: 3)

if only they had been guided!} means, when they see the punishment with their own eyes, they will wish that they had been among the guided in this world. This is like the Ayah, *^ Uuij > jUjwi tfj' lA Syi*

V* (*l> ijLk* jQ' ' M) f/ie Dai/ He u>i// say: "Ca// those partners of Mine whom you claimed." Then they will cry unto them, but they will not answer them, and We shall put a Mawbiq (a barrier) between them. And the criminals, shall see the Fire and apprehend that they have to fall in it. And they will find no way of escape from there.} (18:52-53) Their attitude towards the Messengers on the Day of Resurrection 4And the Day He will call to them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers?"} The first call will be concerning the issue of Tawhid, which includes evidences of the prophethood - *What was your response to the Messengers who were sent to you? How did you deal with them?' This is like the questions which will be asked of a person in his grave: "who is your Lord? who is your Prophet? and what is your religion?" The believer will testify that there is no God except Allah and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger, but the disbelievers will say, "Oh, oh, I do not know." So he will have no answer on the Day of Resurrection except to remain silent, because whoever is blind in this world (i.e., does not see Allah's signs and believes not in Him), will be blind in the Hereafter, and more astray. Allah says: 4Then the news of a good answer will be obscured to them on that Day, and they will not be able to ask one another.} Mujahid said: "The proof will be obscured from them,"¹¹¹ so they will not be able to ask one another for help by virtue of m At-Tabari 19:607.

their blood ties. Allah's saying: J>j ,y1y 4But as for him who repented, believed, and did righteous deeds,} means, in this world. 4then perhaps he will be among those who are successful.} means, on the Day of Resurrection. And the word; perhaps ('Asa), when used in reference to Allah, may He be exalted, implies that the thing described will inevitably come to pass, and this will undoubtedly happen by the grace and mercy of Allah. % 'Ji v i\% Uj&& 4s \$ bb% &Vf 4 ii 468. And your Lord creates whatsoever He wills and chooses, no choice have they. Glorified is Allah, and exalted above all that they associate.} 469. And your Lord knows what their breasts conceal, and what they reveal.} 470. And He is Allah; La ildha ilia Huwa, His is the praise in the first and in the last, and His is the decision, and to Him shall you be returned.} Allah Alone is the One Who has the Power of Creation, Knowledge and Choice Allah tells us that He is the only One Who has the power to create and make decisions, and there is no one who can dispute with Him in that or reverse His judgement. His saying: 4X%3 4And your Lord creates whatsoever He wills and chooses,} means, whatever He wills, for what He wills, happens; and what He does not will, does not happen. All things, good and

437Surah 28. Al-Oasas (68 - 70) (Part-20) bad alike, are in His Hands and will return to Him. ik,'&p& \<f=> C} }no choice have they.} is a negation, according to the correct view. This is like the Ayah, ot 'WP us^ li i iyy % </&, j ilt is not for a believer, man or woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decreed a matter that they should have any option in their decision} (33:36). Then Allah says: 4 - i' pi)J-i> 'J*y & it-" 4 }And your Lord knows what their breasts conceal, and what they reveal.} He knows what is hidden in their hearts, just as He knows what they do openly. ^& / z-' 3^)' j-' 4/f is f/ie same whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day.} (13:10). }And He is Allah; Ld ilaha ilia Huwa,} meaning, He is unique in His divinity, for none is to be worshipped besides Him, and there is no lord who can create what he wills and chooses besides Him. }His is the praise, in the first and in the last,} in all that He does. He is to be praised for His justice and wisdom. 4jfiJ' }His is the decision,} that none can put back, because of His might, power, wisdom and mercy.

438 TafsTr Ibn Kathir iatid to Him shall you be returned.} means, all of you on the Day of Resurrection, and everyone will be re-warded or punished according to his deeds, good and evil alike, and absolutely none of their deeds will be concealed from Him. & js? 4 23 \$} 2. 4 &2 \$ £=4 <2=>2 & j* aJ £ 2\$ \$ & kfi ill o] i£S >2. «\$l n >> i- •i *•' " JJ; |»-4r=»->lj 4l)l jjc Aj] (>• <h\U b6 /Jhj,/ >4/*" {>/•/, / I !>/ >> / / < < *ALi* at aj _A+Dij 471. Say: "TV// me! IfAllah made the night continuousfor you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you light? Will you not then hear?"} 472. Say: "Tell me! IfAllah made the day continuous for you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest? Will you not then see?"} 473. It is out ofHis mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek of His bounty - and in order that you may be grateful.}

439 Surah 28. Al-Oasas (71 - 73) (Part-20 Night and Day are among the Blessings ofAllah and are Signs ofTawhid Allah reminds His servants of His favors towards them by subjugating for them the night and day, without which they could not survive. He explains that if He made the night continuous, lasting until the Day of Resurrection, that would be harmful for them and would cause boredom and stress. So He says: jfi ijj if} iwhich god besides Allah could bring you light?} meaning, “with which you could see things and which would bring you relief?’ & iWill you not then hear?} Then Allah tells us that if He had made the day continuous, lasting until the Day of Resurrection, that would also be harmful for them and their bodies would get tired from so much movement and activity. Allah says: i<J> | ii' j* j-} iwhich god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest?} meaning, ‘to rest from your work and activity.’ rf; & iWill you not then see? It is out ofHis mercy} towards you, ithat He has made for you the night and the day} He created both, 'J&%} ithat you may rest therein} during the night, iand that you may seek ofHis bounty} during the day, by traveling, moving about and working.

iand in order that you may be grateful.} So that you may give thanks to Allah by performing all kinds of acts of worship at night and during the day. Whoever misses something during the night can make it up during the day, and vice versa. This is like the Ayah, i 'J J==0b o' i'J dj• j4' 4 yob iAnd He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession, for such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} (25:62). And there are many similar Ayat iil j^=> at ^ 0? (Jjfr (4* j->j *ii j>j\ J [£& (&*/. ! >*-> d*» 474. And the Day when He will call to them, and will say: “Where are My (so-called) partners, whom you used to assert?”} 475. And We shall take out from every nation a witness, and We shall say: "Bring your proof." Then they shall know that the truth is with Allah, and the lies which they invented will disappear from them.} Rebuking the Idolaters This is another call by way of rebuke for those who worshipped other gods besides Allah. The Lord, may He be exalted, will call to them before all the witnesses, and will say: 4^4>44&& '& 4Where are My (so-called) partners, whom you used to assert?} meaning, in this world. 4And We shall take out from every nation a witness,} Mujahid said, “This means a Messenger.”^ 4f&» s. 'Jd At-Tabari 19:614.

}and We shall say : "Bring your proof."} meaning, ‘of the truth of your claim that Allah had partners.’ any ik 3 iThen they shall blow that the truth is with Allah,} meaning, that there is no god besides Him. Then they will not speak and they will not be able to find any answer. ijii^ if j} 4and the lies which they invented will disappear from them.} they will vanish and will be of no benefit to them. as St E S; i^t" os Si^ ^ 44 v sif l\ £2 v # ju it .1 E2-^ Ciif JLiG jQt iit ^uSt; 4 w.uiaGJ' 4-^; ^ 6} tjiVl j jElllf ^4 yj -oil

476. Verily, Qarun was of Musa's people, but he behaved arrogantly towards them. And We gave him of the treasures, that of which the keys would have been a burden to a body of strong men. Remember when his people said to him: "Do not exult. Verily, Allah likes not those who exult."} 4J7 . But seek, with that which Allah has bestowed on you, the home of the Hereafter, and forget not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world; and be generous as Allah has been generous to you, and seek not mischief in the land. Verily Allah likes not the mischief-makers."} Qarun and His People's exhortation It was recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: oi <GIS=> iifu iVerily, Qarun was of Musa's people,} "He was the son of his paternal uncle."111 This was also the view of Ibrahim An-Nakha'I, 'Abdullah bin Al-Harith bin m Ibn Abi Hatim 9 :3005.

His saying: SS \Li ^0 <U £± •£ i^if ifcill 4Bid seek, with that which Allah has be- stowed on you, the home of the Hereafter, andfor- get not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world;} means, 'use this great wealth and immense blessing Allah has given you to worship your Lord and draw closer to Him by doing a variety of good deeds which will earn you reward in this world and the Hereafter.' 40j)' iand forget not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world;} That which Allah has permitted of food, drink, clothing, dwelling places and women. Your Lord has rights over you, your self has rights over you, your family has rights over you, and your visitors have rights over you. So give each of them their due.' }and be generous as Allah has been generous to you,} "Be generous to His creatures, as He has been generous to you.' O" 4 scarg%} iand seek not mischief in the land.} meaning: 'do not let your aim & tgsaga ^ (.Hi >• -'A'"" -r L. <1 Q 1 S. iV A. - t . ^ ^ . > , ' -tif ^ & sgssjk*{\$

^4 <J* Li 4He said: "This has been given to me only because of the knowledge I possess."} He said: "Were it not for the fact that Allah is pleased with me and knows my virtue, He would not have given me this wealth." And He said: 4fo; <i> - it aijil ji iii fo} 4Did he not know that Allah had destroyed before him generations, men who were stronger than him in might and greater in the amount they had collected?} 1^ This is what those who have little knowledge say when they see a person whom Allah has granted a lot of wealth; they say that if he did not deserve it, Allah would not have given it to him. z&a Gif iESi JU^ j^ & 'fpf &%\$ 4*£p-% gj Jtfj & -ftA^ *^1 '< V_> Lai 479. So, /jo went forth before his people in his finery. Those who were desirous of the life of the world, said: "Ah, would that we had the like of what Qarun has been given! Verily, he is the owner of a great fortune."} 480. But those who had been given knowledge said: "Woe to you! The reward of Allah is better for those who believe and do righteous deeds, and this none shall attain except the patient."} How Qarun went forth in His Finery, and His People's Comments Allah tells us how Qarun went forth one day before his people with his magnificent regalia; wearing his fine clothes, accompanied by his fine horses, his servants and retinue. When those whose desires and inclinations were for the world saw his adornments and splendor, they wished that they could have the same as he had been given, and said: m Al-Tabari 19:626.

i yiA c& 13 4A/i, would f/wf we /iod die like of what Qdriin has been given! Verily, he is the owner of a great fortune.} meaning, "he is very lucky and has a great share in this world.' When the people of beneficial knowledge heard this, they said to them: 4'A** IMj Q jif 4*1r 4Woe to you! The reward of Allah is better for those who believe and do righteous deeds,} 'Allah's reward to His believing, righteous servants in the Hereafter is better than what you see,' as is reported in the authentic Hadith: 'Jj viJtw ll\ Nj of; N U oeJUJl ojfff :JU: lil owl of ^ : 'j s~i 3^ uAllah has prepared for His righteous

servants what no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and the heart of a human cannot comprehend. Recite, if you wish: 4N0 person knows what is kept hidden for them of joy as a reward for what they used to do.} * (32: 17).m 4& \$} iand this none shall attain except the patient.} As-Suddi said: "None shall reach Paradise except for the patient" - as if this were the completion of the statement made by the people of knowledge.*2 ' Ibn Jarir said, "This applies only to those who patiently forsake the love of this world, seeking the Hereafter. It is as if this is part of what the people of knowledge said, but it is made part of the Words of Allah, stating this fact."*3' < / ,/•' if . > v >> ^ '•tit / / \ Cj* Uj aui gy* # CK la *4i i ;i ..'Xy FathAl-B&ri 8:375. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 9:3016. *3) FathAl-Bdri 10 :269

& J21 & <<kz 0jJ>; '42CMgk 4lt y /Ot&y ^ ii-wl tie iii ly* J Vj) jJkiy j; *Llj 4S2 . So, We caused the earth to swallow him and his dwelling place. Then he had no group to help him against Allah, nor was he one of those who could save themselves 482 . And those who desired his position the day before, began to say: "Know you not that it is Allah Who expands the provision or restricts it to whomsoever He pleases of His servants. Had it not been that Allah was Gracious to us, He could have caused the earth to swallow us up! Know you not that the disbelievers will never be successful."} HowQarunandHis DwellingPlacewereswallowedupby the Earth After telling us about Qartin's conceit and pride in his adornments, and how he was arrogant towards his people and transgressed against them, Allah then tells us how he and his dwelling place were swallowed up by the earth. This was also reported in the Sahih by Al-Bukhari from Salim, who said that his father told him that the Messenger of Allah jg said: fji iJl c*? ' i\ »jjl 'j>4 ' 'While a man was dragging his lower garment, he was swallowed up and he will remain sinking down into the earth until the Day of Resurrection .» He also recorded something similar from Salim from Abu Hurayrah from the Prophet sg. ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said said, "The Messenger of Allah said: 4)1 y\ iU(j (ry1 "Wlten a man among the people who came before you went out wearing two green garments, walking proudly and arrogantly, Allah commanded the earth to swallow him up, and he will remain sinking down into it until the Day of (M At-Tabari 19 :629

Resurrection This version was recorded only by Ahmad, and its chain of narration is Hasan (sound). i>2 /I iA*"—» Li^ iThen he had no group to help him against AIMi, nor was he one of those who could save themselves.} means, his wealth, group, servants and retinue were of no avail to him; they could not protect him from the wrath and vengeance of Allah. Nor could he help himself or save himself. There was no one to help him, neither himself nor anybody else. His People learned a Lesson from Him being swallowed up Allah's saying: iAnd those who had desired his position the day before,} means, those witnessed him with his finery and said: iThose who were desirous of the life of the world, said: "Ah, would that we had the like of what Qariin has been given! Verily, he is the owner of a great fortune."} When he was swallowed up in the earth, they began to say: 4jAL> 'i-A ce 'A. A, Axif } 4Know you not that it is Allah Who expands the provision or restricts it to whomsoever He pleases of His servants.} Wealth does not indicate that Allah is pleased with its owner, for Allah gives and withholds, allows times of difficulty and times of ease, raises and lowers, His is the most complete wisdom and most convincing proof. According to a Hadlth narrated by Ibn MasMd, m Ahmad 3 :40

SjJ y. jdi jjs ai l\j jui }Jzz jui a>i o>» w j; v'5 & lAllah has allotted character among you just as He has allotted your provision. Allah gives wealth to those whom He loves and those whom He does not love,

but He gives Faith only to those whom He /oues." 1 ' clliJ (•£ iit 3 V\$} 4Had it not been that Allah was Gracious to us, He could have caused the earth to szoallow us up!} meaning, "were it not for the kindness and grace of Allah towards us, we could have been swallowed up by the earth just as he was swallowed up, because we wanted to be like him." i&p '& i iKnow you not that the disbelievers will never be successful.} He was a disbeliever, and the disbelievers will never be successful before Allah in this world or in the Hereafter. k:UPi. tdb a 4\$ * id,i &j} U "Jl Cjli-Sll iuult tfci |>*J Ifi* j*i- /(!» ii-it •Kt- 483 . That is the home of the Hereafter, We s/ia// assign to those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land nor cause corruption. And the good end isfor those who have Taqwa.} 484. Whosoever brings good, he shall have the better thereof; and whosoever brings evil, then those who do evil deeds will only be requitedfor what they used to do.} The Blessings ofthe Hereafter for the humble Believers Allah tells us that He has made the home of the Hereafter, and its eternal delights which will never change or fade away, for His believing, humble servants who do not rebel against the truth with pride and oppression in the land. They do not 111 Ahmad 1:387.

exalt themselves above the creatures of Allah, arrogantly oppressing them and spreading corruption among them. Ikrimah said that this phrase referred to haughtiness and arrogance. 1 ^ Ibn Jurayj said: 4those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land^ "Arrogance and tyranny, 4'b v;> inor cause corruption committing sins."121 Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Ali said, "If a man wants the straps of his sandals to be better than the straps of his companion's sandals, then he is one ofthose referred to in the Ayah, \$3\$ ib Vj i;-jgtR jiS(iThat is the home of the Hereafter, We shall assign to those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land nor cause corruption. And the good end is far those who have Taqwdy3] This is understood to mean that if his intention is to show off and appear better than others, then that is to be condemned, as it was reported in the Sahih that the Prophet sgg said: J*^ ^ J* -b J*- oi Q\ ^rj\ "It has been revealed to me that you should be humble to the extent that none ofyou boasts to others or mistreats others .»14 But if a person simply likes to look good, then there is nothing wrong with that. It was recorded that a man said: "O Messenger of Allah, I like to have my garment looking good and my shoes looking good - is this a kind of arrogance?" The Prophet |S\$ said: At-Tabari 19:637. At-Tabari 19:637. At-Tabari 19:638. 141 Muslim 4:2199.

Jr >c rw mm ^Oj^ Wus 0 ill o;oyJ'^ ^'oJ*. ojc;^i0^joja@i>ii i/rr> 4^4 j-^- si oi ^ •JUAJI oNo, /or AMaii is beautiful and loves beauty ...»,1) And Allah says: it o# {Whosoever brings good,} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, % Jfc {he shall have the better thereof;} meaning, the reward of Allah is bet- ter than the good deeds of His servant - how can it not be, when Allah has multi- plied it many times over? This is the posi- tion of generosity. Then Allah says: \y^ ^ *1 {and whosoever brings evil, then those who do evil deeds will only be requitedfor what they used to do.} This is like the Ayah, {^*£2 <£&l jiJ* 4 '* <Z> {And whoever brings an evil deed, they will be cast down on their faces in the Fire. (And it will be said to them) "Are you being recompensed anything except what you used to do?"} (27:90). This is the postition of generosity and justice. **' Muslim 1 :93.

452 Tafslr Ibn Kathir J* Irj iSxii '£ o' Jj ji 2S). £<><£& aL& J,J cf it c,i^ v^***' -^4 z£? o' lAy £> <^iu> j 4 2£4 ijJ i> m i> y& £ Jii; Vj ^Jcs *£££ 4 v >': \$1 it £ g£ Sfj ^s^ vj dis 4s V) 4ii ^55. Verify, He Who has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the return. Say: "My Lord is Aware ofhim who brings guidance, and ofhim who is in manifest error."} 486. And you were not expecting that the Book

would be sent down to you, but it is a mercy from your Lord. So never be a supporter of the disbelievers .} 487 . And let them not turn you away from the Aydt of Allah after they have been sent down to you, and invite to your Lord and be not of idolaters.} 488. And invoke not any other god along with Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa. Everything will perish save His Face. His is the decision, and to Him you shall be returned.} The Command to convey the Message ofTawhxd Here Allah commands His Messenger jg to convey the Message and recite the Qur'an to people. He tells him that he will be brought back to the return, which is the Day of Resurrection, where he will be asked about the prophethood he was entrusted with. So Allah says: 4)C4 ^Xji\ Alxfc Jfft jJ l\} 4Verily, He Wlw has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the rehim.} meaning, the One Who has commanded you to put it into practice among mankind,' 4)C41%} 4will surely bring you back to the return.} 'On the Day of Resurrection, where He will question you concerning that,' as Allah said: K SJ '&}

453Surah 28. Al-Oasas (85 - 88) (Part-20) iThen surely, We shall question those to whom it was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers.} (7:6) Allah said: ISC £# iSf 0 iOn the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them: "What was the response you received?"} (5:109). And He said: 4and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward} (39:69) In his Tafsir of his Sahlh, Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah 4m iwill surely bring you back to the return.} "To Makkah."11 ' This was also recorded by An-Nasal in his Tafsir in his Sunan,'2 ' and by Ibn Jarir.13' Al-'Awfi also reported from Ibn 'Abbas that the phrase: 4m iwill surely bring you back to the return.} means, "will surely bring you back to Makkah as He brought you out of it."14 ' Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded that Mujahid commented on: iwill surely bring you back to the return.} He said, "Back to your place of birth in Makkah."15' Ibn 'Abbas is also reported to have interpreted it variously referring to death, to the Day of Resurrection which will come 111 Fath Al-BOri8:369. ,2' An-Nasal in Al-Kubra6 :425 ' At-Tabari 19:641. 141 At-Tabari 19:641. At-Tabari 19:641.

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir after death, and to Paradise which will be his reward and his destiny for putting the Message of Allah into practice and conveying it to the humans and Jinns, and because he is the most perfect, most eloquent and most noble of all the creation of Allah. Allah's saying: 4 J* J'j 'Z ij* pH frf iSay: "My Lord is Aware ofhim who brings guidance, and of him who is in manifest error."} means: "Say, O Muhammad, to those among your people who oppose you and disbelieve you, among the idolators and those who follow them in their disbelief, 'My Lord knows best which of us, you or I, is rightly guided, and you will come to know for which of us will be the (happy) end in the Hereafter, and for which of us will be a good end and victoiy in this world and in the Hereafter'." Then Allah reminds His Prophet the numerous blessings He granted to him and mankind by virtue of sending him to them: ^H) off J C,} iAnd you were not expecting that the Book would be sent down to you,} 'Before the revelation was sent down to you, you did not expect that revelation would be sent down to you.' ibut it is a mercyfrom your Lord.} means, but revelation has been sent down to you from Allah as a mercy to you and to mankind because of you. Since Allah has granted you this great blessing,' iSo never be a supporter} i.e., a helper, ipf the disbelievers.} rather, separate from them, hostility towards them and oppose them.' Jju CZi)* (jP 'express your

iAnd let them not turn you away from the Ayat ofAllah after they have been sent down to you.} meaning, 'Do not let their opposition to you affect you or put people off from following your way; do

not worry about that or pay any attention to it, for Allah will make your word supreme, will support your religion and will make the Message with which He has sent you prevail over all other religions.' So He says: *ms4 iand invite to your Lord*} to worship your Lord Alone, with no partners or associates, *4S&X U&&W iand be not of idoiators.*} ^And invoke not any other god along with Allah, there is no God but Him.} means, it is not appropriate to worship anything or anybody except Him, and divinity does not befit any except His glory. *msifa& 4Everything will perish save His Face'.*} Here Allah is telling us that He is Eternal, Ever Lasting, Ever Living, Self-Sustaining, Who, although His creation dies, He will never die, as He says: ^Whatsoever is on it will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and I nor will remain forever.} (55:26-27). Allah used the word "Face" to refer to Himself, as He says here: *ms'iifa.^!?*} 4Everything will perish save His Face.} meaning, everything except Him. It was reported in the Sahih. via Abu Salamah that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: 3— JLU 'SS- t* — -rJ ^ G

456 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir "The truest word of a poet was the saying of Labid - indeed everything except Allah is false.s'11 ip5 i> iHis is the decision> means, dominion and control, and there is none who can reverse His judgement or decision. i4& iand to Him you shall be returned.^ means, on the Day when you will be brought back, and He will reward or punish you according to your deeds: if they are good, then you will be rewarded, and if they are bad, then you will be punished.

Surah 29: Al-Ankabut

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4323–4340]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Ankabut (Chapter - 29) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} 43. And We indeed tested those who were before them so that Allah will indeed know those who are true, and He will know those who are liars.} 44. Or think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us? Evil is that which they judge!} The Believers are tested so that it may be known Who is Sincere and Who is Lying In the beginning of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, we discussed the letters which appear at the beginning of some Surahs. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} This is a rebuke in the form of a question, meaning that Allah will inevitably test His believing servants according to their level of faith, as it recorded in the authentic Hadith. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} This is a rebuke in the form of a question, meaning that Allah will inevitably test His believing servants according to their level of faith, as it recorded in the authentic Hadith.

is the view of Ibn ‘Abbas and others concerning phrases such as the Ayah, {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} (2:143).
111 Meaning, only to see - because seeing has to do with

what is there, but knowledge is broader than seeing, since it includes what is not present as well as what is. The Evil doers cannot escape from Allah Allah said: {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} means, those who are not believers should not think that they will escape such trials and tests, for ahead of them lies a greater and more severe punishment. Allah says: {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} meaning, “escape” from Us. Please note that these Ayat are usually translated with the meaning of Allah “tests” instead of “will know.” They are to be understood with that general meaning as well as the explanation above.

461 Surah 29. (5 - 8) Al-Ankabut (Part-20) Whoever does a righteous deed, the benefit of that deed will come back to him, for Allah has no need of the deeds of His servants, and even if all of them were to be as pious as the most pious man among them, that would not add to His dominion in the slightest. Allah says: {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} And whosoever strives, he strives only for himself. Verily, Allah stands not in need of any of the creatures. Then Allah tells us that even though He has no need of His creatures, He is kind and generous to them. He will still give to those who believe and do righteous deeds the best of rewards, which is that He will expiate for them their bad deeds, and will reward them according to the best deeds that they did. He will accept the fewest good deeds and in return for one good deed will give

anything between ten rewards and seven hundred, but for every bad deed, He will give only one evil merit, or even that He may overlook and forgive. This is like the Ayah, *y • S'*, iSurely, Allah wrongs not even the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good, He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward. (4:40). And He says here: iThose who believe, and do righteous good deeds, surely, We shall expiate from them their evil deeds and We shall indeed reward them according to the best of that which they used to do.\$ cl Uj 48. And We have enjoined on man to be dutiful to his parents; but if they strive to make you associate with Me, which you

463Surah 29.(10-11) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20 gathered on the Day of Resurrection with those whom he loves, meaning, religious love. Allah says: 4 \jiSj \yX Sj# 4And for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, surely, We shall make them enter with the righteous.) In his Tafsir of this Ayah, At-Tirmidhi recorded that Sa'd said: "Four Ayat were revealed concerning me - and he told his story. He said: "Umm Sa'd said: 'Did Allah not command you to honor your parents? By Allah, I will not eat or drink anything until I die or you renounce Islam.' When they wanted to feed her, they would force her mouth open. Then this Ayah was revealed: 4And We have enjoined on man to be dutiful to his parents; but if they strive to make you associate with Me, ofwhich you have no knowledge, then obey them not.' I] This Hadith was also recorded by Imam Ahmad, Muslim, Abu Dawud and An-Nasal. 121 At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih." ojJj *i\ ojL3' 5«*-\$ 4 4#^ 4*4 i>* uj&' _yi£» 4 bf ir? % ^=* yjiJ 410. Of mankind are some who say: "We believe in Allah." But if they are made to suffer for Allah, they consider the trial of mankind as Allah's punishment; and if victory comes from your Lord, they will say: "Verily, we were with you." Is not Allah Best Aware ofwhat is in the breasts of the creatures?} 411 . And indeed Allah knows those who believe, and verily, He knows the hypocrites.} I1 ' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :48 ' Ahmad 1:181, Muslim 4 :1877 , Abu Dawud 3 :177 , An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :348

The Attitudes ofthe Hypocrites and theWays in which Allah tests People Allah mentions the descriptions of the liars who falsely claim faith with their lips, while faith is not firm in their hearts. When a test or trial comes in this world, they think that this is a punishment from Allah, so they leave Islam. Allah says: ojdtf alii jii-4 j liji iOfmankind are some who say: "We believe in Allah." Blit if they are made to suffer for Allah, they consider the trial of mankind as Allah's punishment;} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Meaning that their trial is leaving Islam if they sire made to suffer for Allah." This was also the view of others among the Salaf. This Ayah is like the Ayah, 4*< iAnd among mankind is he who worships Allah as it were upon the edge: ifgood befalls him, he is content therewith; but ifa trial befalls him, he films back on hisface...} until: 4444 4d#} iThat is a strayingfar away} [22:1 1-121- Then Allah says: 4\$z 4&4 44} iand if victory comes from your Lord, they will say: "Verily we were with you."} meaning, "if victoiy comes from your Lord, O Muhammad, and there are spoils of war, these people will say to you, *We were with you,' i.e., we are your brothers in faith." This is like the Ayat U&bX&jfes J3 jff rj&4 4 <&4 -jM} 4kt& -A itm * iThose who wait and watch about you; if you gain a victory m At-Tabari 20 :13.

465Surah 29. (10 - 11) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) from Allah, they say: "Were we not with you?" But if the disbelievers gain a success, they say (to them): "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?") (4:141). ^Perhaps Allah may bring a victory or a decision according to His will. Then they will become regretful for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves)

(5:52). And Allah tells us about them here: and if victory comes from your Lord, they will say: "Verily, we were with you") Then Allah says: jji, ^ Lj jJeL ft j) ils not Allah Best Aware of what is in the breasts of the creatures?) meaning, 'does Allah not know best what is in their hearts and what they store secretly within themselves, even though outwardly they may appear to be in agreement with you?' E'4\$ ft iAnd indeed Allah knows those who believe, and verily He knows the hypocrites.) Allah will test the people with calamities and with times of ease, so that He may distinguish the believers from the hypocrites, to see who will obey Allah both in times of hardship and of ease, and who will obey Him only when things are going in accordance with their desires. As Allah says: iAnd surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard and the patient, and We shall test your facts.) (47:31) After the battle of Uhud, with its trials and tribulations for the Muslims, Allah said: ii&i UUpU ^ U ft tit 6)

itf& ^And no friend will ask a friend (about his condition), though they shall be made to see one another) (70:10-11). iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.) Here Allah tells us that those who call others to disbelief and misguidance will, on the Day of Resurrection, bear their own sins and the sins of others, because of the people they misguided. Yet that will not detract from the burden of those other people in the slightest, as Allah says: A. iThat they may bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge) (16:25). In the Sahih, it says: jlp ja fj 4*5' J* J'~t j4-^' Ijl ^^ 15-** ^ O' Ja fill 34 Jt S* jVS Iji b^-^ "1~S J-frj'5 ' bi b^-^ jA bf ^ ^Whoever calls others to true guidance, will have a reward like that of those who follow him until the Day of Resurrection, without it detracting from their reward in the slightest. Whoever calls others to misguidance, will have a burden of sin like that of those who follow him until the Day of Resurrection, without it detracting from their burden in the slightest, s'11 In the Sahih, it also says: & -Ja Jjt a*>btjk ^ «jaai <tNo person is killed unlawfully, but a share of the guilt will be upon the first son of Adam, because he was the first one to l1 ' Muslim 4 :2060

initiate the idea of killing another. »(1) verily, they shall be questioned on the Day of Resurrection about that which they used to fabricate means, the lies they used to tell and the falsehood they used to fabricate. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Umamah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jgg conveyed the Message with which he was sent, then he said: Jlii ja *i& ^ (li y jlli tjs lii p ijiik J4-j j* <J-*i If*. sjf \+5\ i-Ul ^ 0* ^ o* XP uvt j\ U12 3 cJis if p ^ A > 1 / J << A , 9 t * t * t + >• + , y) X Uj-ls-o jylji Vi ijJLls- cT^^ \j~a»\ '.dy^ loU^Atll ^ ji_j t C^>- 14^* V i g - «4lip U^LjI-U ja Ijisi : J_jij <.ZjJ~ <J jj i^Ju* ft- ^Beware of injustice, for Allah will swear an oath of the Day of Resurrection and will say: "By My glory and majesty, no injustice will be overlooked today." Then a voice will call out, "Where is so-and-so the son of so-and-so?" He will be brought forth, followed by his good deeds which appear like mountains while the people are gazing at them in wonder, until he is standing before the Most Merciful. Then the caller will be commanded to say: "Whoever is owed anything by so-and-so the son of so-and-so, or has been wronged by him, let him come forth." So they will come forth and gather before the Most Merciful, then the Most Merciful will say: "Settle the matter for My servant." They will say, "How can we settle the matter?" He will say, "Take from his good deeds and give it to them." They will keep taking from his good deeds until there is nothing left, and there will still be people with scores to be settled. Allah will say, "Settle the matter for My servant." They will [11 FathAl-BOri 6:419.

rw x" >*- 4^ £\$0 (*»-V^aj vj*£p *""4 aA^LJaJj^VlU """,i *AAa2A.LiJL2lj1)^»J^ say, "He does not have even one good deed left." Allah will say, "Take from their evil deeds and give them to him." Then the Prophet jgq quoted this Ayah: £ •\$\$; j\$S & peg £ \$3; jAfiSf ^And verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own ; and verily, they shall be questioned on the Day of Resurrection about that which they used to fabricate.^' There is a corroborating report in the Sahih with a different chain of narration: ju iU} iili jjk jij ji^Ji j£t oi^ uaii f>: ^tj j^ji !>|» IS^i iJLij ^ iJLi jb^ti itJLi o*'': Iri ' ^ «A man wi// come on the Day of Resurrection with good deeds like mountains, but he had wronged this one, taken the wealth of that one and slandered the honor of another. So each of them will take from his good deeds . And if there is nothing left of his good deeds, it will be taken from their evil and placed on l 1 ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5 :272

472 Surah 29. (14 - 25) Al-'Ankabat (Part-20) mission when he was forty years old, and he stayed among his people for a thousand years less fifty; after the Flood he lived for sixty years until people had increased and spread." iThen We saved him and the Companions of the Boat,} means, those who believed in NClIj, peace be upon him. We have already discussed this in detail in Surah Hud,*2 * and there is no need to repeat it here. iand made it (the ship) an Ayah for all people.} means. We caused that ship to remain,' whether in itself, as Qatadah said, that it remained until the beginning of Islam, on Mount Jttdi, or whether the concept of sailing in ships was left as a reminder to mankind of how Allah had saved them from the Flood.*3 * This is like the Ayat iAnd an Ayah for them is that We bore their offspring in the laden ship. And We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride until: iand as an enjoyment for a while [36:41-44]. iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits. We carried you in the ship. That We might make it an admonition for you and that it might be retained by the retaining ears.} (69:11-12) And Allah says here: SSK & iThen We saved him and the Companions of the Boat, and made it an Ayah for all people.} This is a shift from referring to one specific ship to speaking *** Ibn Abi H&tim no. 17186, Ad-DurrAl-ManthOr 5 :273 * See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (10 :25) <3 > At-Tabari 20:18.

worship Allah alone, with no partner or associate, to fear Him alone, to seek provision from Him alone, with no partner or associate, to give thanks to Him alone, for He is the One to Whom thanks should be given for the blessings which none can bestow but He. Ibrahim said to his people: it 4Worship Allah, and have Tacfwd of Him,} meaning worship Him and fear Him Alone, with all sincerity. ithat is better for you if you know.} if you do that you will attain good in this world and the next, and you will prevent evil from yourselves in this world and the Hereafter. Then Allah states that the idols which they worshipped were not able to do any harm or any good, and tells them, "You made up names for them and called them gods, but they are created beings just like you." This interpretation was reported by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas. 1 11 It was also the view of Mujahid and As-Suddl. Al-Walibi reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "You invent falsehood, means, you carve idols,"¹²¹ which do not have the power to provide for you. 4-^2' \$ is 4so seek from Allah your provision,} This emphasizes the idea of asking Allah Alone. This is like the Ayat 4You (Alone) we worship, and You (Alone) we ask for help.} (1:5) And His saying: 4My Lord! Build for me, with You, a home in Paradise} (66:11). Allah says here: At-Jabari 20:19. Al-Tabari 20:19.

iso seek} meaning, ask for 44\$\$\$ x%} ifrom Allah your provision,} meaning, do not seek it from anyone or anything other than Him, for no one else possesses the power to do anything. iand worship Him, and be grateful to Him.} Eat from what He has provided and worship Him Alone, and give thanks to Him for the blessings He has given you. 4To Him you will be brought back.} means, on the Day of Resurrection, when He will reward or punish each person according to his deeds. His saying: ip&J oi X^ vjjk=a lii 0\$} iAnd ifyou deny, then nations before you have denied.} means, “you have heard what happened to them by way of punishment for opposing the Messengers.’ cjEJt % <£)’ & iAnd the duty of the Messenger is only to convey plainly.} All the Messengers have to do is to convey the Message as Allah has commanded them. Allah guides whoever He wills and leaves astray whoever He wills, so strive to be among the blessed. Qatadah said concerning the Ayah: 4 (Oi X^ '->>£=* Jii & of}} iAnd ifyou deny, then nations before you have denied.} “These are words of consolation to His Prophet, peace be upon him.” This suggestion by Qatadah implies that the narrative (about Ibrahim) is interrupted here, and resumes with the words “And nothing was the answer of (Ibrahim’s) people...” in

Ayah 24. This was also stated by Ibn Jarir. From the context

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4340–4353]

it appears that Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said all ofwhat is in this section. Here he establishes proof against them that the Resurrection will indeed come to pass, because at the end of this passage it says: 4 ltrij £=> &} 4“And nothing was the answer ofhis people...’>(29:24) And Allah knows best. !&* \$ k 3 &£ !£? fit }£ 3 % 12* 32 dEi ti; 1^6 ^Vi^ 4 Ji BJ #<£#2 fcS * j££ «£ * 443 U/-^" Xj £lj iyj oj 4*tic jvi oj [y-fc-i <19. See they not how Allah originates the creation, then repeats it. Verily, that is easyfar Allah.} 420. Say: "Travel in the land and see how He originated the creation, and then Allah will bring forth the creation of the Hereafter. Verily, Allah is able to do all things."} 421 . He punishes whom He wills, and shows mercy to whom He wills; and to Him you will be returned.} 422 . And you cannot escape in the earth or in the heaven . And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.} 423. And those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah and meeting with Him, such have no hope ofMy mercy: and far such there is a painful torment.} The Evidence for Life after Death Allah tells us that Ibrahim, peace be upon him, showed them the proof of life after death, which they denied, in their souls. For Allah created them after they had been nothing at all, then they came into existence and became people who could hear and see. The One Who originated this is able to repeat it, it is very easy for Him. Then he taught them to contemplate the visible signs on the horizons and the things that Allah has created: the heavens with their stars and planets, moving and stationary, the earth with its plains and mountains, its valleys,

J T\\ mm% Jjj 'j pj a Uii>*4tt^OJJ A-** l j^JUjQp 1/iem.B111 Allah says: &s * ,u>j ss * 4^s> 4He punishes whom He wills, and shows mercy to whom He wills; and to Him you will be returned You will return to Him on the Day of Resurrection. ojiSVf (4 OjyyL Cj^ i| Y» 4And you cannot escape on the earth or in the heaven.) No one in heaven or on earth can flee from Him, for He is the Subduer Who is above His servants, and everything fears Him and is in need of Him, while He is the One Who is Independent of all else. 4if L Lti-5^ <ZsMj l|p Xj £) o; iyj o; ^=J Cy^ 4**^ 4And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper. And those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah and the

meeting with Him,) Those who disbelieved in the signs of Allah and denied the Resurrection, 4i^»y iti i
ia! m Abu Dawud 5 :75 , Ibn Majah 1 :30

isuch have no hope ofMy mercy> they will have no share in it, i/j,*p dizifo} iandfor such there is a
painful torment.} meaning, extremely painful, in this world and the next. Jilj 4 jUlf ia(lljili yij> _>1
ybji ijUl 4 tj yliji 4 (•£"?*~? taj ji' i>J,J 1*^1 34> fjk liJ? paO. ufVj. tjj!' 424. So nothing was the answer
ofpeople except that they said : "Kill him or bum him." Then Allah saved him from the fire. Verily, in
this are indeed signsfor a people who believe.} 425. And (Ibrahim) said: "You have taken idols instead
of Allah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you
shall deny each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you shall have no
helper."} The Response of Ibrahim's People - and how Allah controlled the Fire Allah tells us how
Ibrahim's people stubbornly and arrogantly disbelieved, and how they resisted the truth with falsehood.
After Ibrahim addressed them with his words of clear guidance, 4\& j\ :j& tfu 4 H[] iexcept that they
said: "Kill him or bum him."} This was because proof had clearly been established against them, so
they resorted to using their power and strength. 4%'uOtt pO- GT^ i/4 4^^\$ iThey said : "Build for him a
building and throw him into the blazing fire!" So they plotted a plot against him, but We made them the
lowest.} (37:97-98). They spent a long time gathering a huge amount of firewood,

they built a fence around it, then they set it ablaze until its flames reached up to the sky. No greater fire
had ever been lit. Then they went to Ibrahim, seized him and put him into a catapult, then they threw
him into the fire. But Allah made it cool and safe for him, and after spending several days in it, he
emerged unscathed. For this reason and others, Allah made him an Imam for mankind, for he offered
himself to the Most Merciful, he offered his body to the flames, he offered his son as a sacrifice, and he
gave his wealth to care for his guests. For all of these reasons he is beloved by the followers of all
religions. ^Then Allah saved him from the fire.} means, He rescued him from it by making it cool and
safe for him. fA 9\$ <4* 4 iVerily, in this are indeed signsfor a people who believe. Ibrahim, peace be
upon him, explains to his people that idols are incapable of doing anything, Jl j Ojl tiyiA &J3 S&j} }
And (Ibrahim) said: "You luroe taken idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life
ofthis world,} Here Ibrahim was rebuking his people for their evil deed of worshipping idols, and
telling them: 'You have taken these as gods and you come together to worship them so that there is
friendship and love among you in this world,' ibut on the Day of Resurrection,} the situation will be the
opposite, and this love and friendship will turn into hatred and enmity. Then iyou shall deny each
other,} meaning, you will denounce one another and deny whatever was between you,} and curse each
other,} means, the followers will curse their

relationship was to him, Ibrahim said, "My sister." Then he went to her and said, "I told him that you
are my sister, so do not let him think I am lying, for there are no believers on earth except for you and I,
and you are my sister in faith." It seems - and Allah knows best - that the meaning here is, there is no
other Muslim couple on earth apart from you and I. Among his people, only Lut believed in him and
migrated with him to Syria, then during Ibrahim's lifetime he was sent as a Messenger to the people of
Sadum (Sodom) where he settled. 1 11 We have already discussed their stoy and more is to come. iHe
(Ibrahim) said: "I will emigratefor the sake ofmy Lord."} It may be that the pronoun in the verb "he
said" refers to Lut, because he was the last person mentioned before this phrase; or it may refer to

Ibrahim. Ibn 'Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said that Ibrahim is the one who is referred in the phrase. *ilj JS'Eu» }So, Lut believed in him.} i.e., out of all his people. Then Allah tells us that he chose to leave them so that he might be able to follow his religion openly. So he said: iVerily, He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} Power belongs to Him and to His Messenger and to those who believe in him, and He is Wise in all that He says and does, and in all His rulings and decrees, both universal and legislative. Qatadah said, "They migrated together from Kutha, which is on the outskirts of Kufa, and went to Syria."*¹²¹ Allah gave Ibrahim, Ishaq and Ya'qub, and ordained Prophethood in His Offspring ¹¹¹ Fath Al-Bari 6 :447 ¹²¹ At-Tabari 20:26.

*}And We bestowed on him, Isliaq and Ya'qub,} This is like the Ayah, ' *? , Lijj i&r ytj J>«1[lil lLk> «jjt op CSI (A**'' 4So, when he had turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one ofthem We made a Prophet.} (19:49) That is, when he left his people, Allah gave him joy in a righteous son who was also a Prophet, to whom in turn was bom, in his grandfather's lifetime, a righteous son who was also a Prophet. Allah also says: 4And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and Ya'qub in addition (21:72) meaning, as an additional gift. This is like the Ayah, 4But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.} (11:71) meaning, to this son would be born a son during their lives, who would be a delight to them. 4^01) Xy~& irv* ti hiZ>-j} }and We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book,} This is a tremendous blessing. Not only did Allah take him as a close friend and make him an Imam for mankind, but He also ordained prophethood and the Book among his offspring. After the time of Ibrahim there was no Prophet who was not from among his descendants. All of the Prophets of the Children of Israel were from among his descendants, from Ya'qub bin Ishaq bin Ibrahim to the last of them, Isa bin Maryam, who stood in the midst of his people and announced the good news of the Hashimi Qurashi Arab Prophet, the last of all the Messengers, the leader of the sons of Adam in this world and the next, whom Allah chose from the heart of the Arab nation, from the descendants of Ismail bin Ibrahim, may peace be upon them. There is no Prophet from the line of*

483Siirah 29. (27 - 30) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) Ismail besides him, may the best of blessings and peace be upon him. 4and We granted him his reward in this world; and verily i« the Hereafter he is indeed among the righteous .} Allah granted him happiness in this world that was connected to happiness in the Hereafter, for in this world he had plentiful provision, a splendid home, a beautiful and righteous wife, and he was and still is spoken of highly, for everyone loves him and regards him as a friend. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: "He obeyed Allah in all ways." This is like the Ayah, iAnd ofIbrahim who fulfilled all.} (53:37) He did all that he was commanded to do and obeyed his Lord to the utmost. Allah says: g£& 4% KSif 4^ iand We granted him his reward in this world; and verily, in the Hereafter he is indeed among the righteous.} And He says: to iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, Qdnit to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the idolaters} until: tj \$ff} iand in the Hereafter he shall be ofthe righteous} (16:120-122). sft Ju-1 Cfl 1^4; oytj j£=c.Ilf £*& j J.i/Jf jfUbjuj JI^f Sj 4 if Giif ijd J^^ a ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 20:27 28. ¹²¹ See volume six, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Isrn' (16-120).*

485Surah 29. (31 - 35) Al-'Ankabiit (Part-20) J 1 UU^JUiSj i-J 1; .tf^UL.ijocU-Dj y«» s <*y lfc)j v^SUi y|>f: '~y*U»j!LiiiyO jS r« ^_a-) aJJJS -p'j *;/_j~a "\. ^T*' ' fl -' '*~ JL-ai :* <1jU4£)j^ ^==^0-: ^ t^gjUga Allah's torment upon us if you are one of the truthful."} This is indicative of their*

disbelief, scornful attitude and stubbornness. So Allah's Prophet asked for help against them, and said: *jjN\ Jf- 4<2-J-Ji-^ 4My Lord! Give me victory over the people who are corrupt.*} X3L1J tij} jii dj tfii ^4L iyLfS> L+Lkl 6} ?— >olk dSi Jii C® & 0^S >. vt juij a t/ ^ yu a; "il yU_> le>S |»4> |*j; ».~y (3yl Lvl<j Ollj» c? 0i C*!*=—=> £ ^JW ill ^ i 4*2 q *2 £ a lii aFi; t^=v jiJ iy^ tL ^ !>*v >' i -j±' >,— <; 431 . And when Our messengers came to Ibrahim with the glad tidings they said: "Verily, we are going to destroy the people of this town; truly, its people have been wrongdoers."} 432. Ibrahim said: "But there is Lut in it." They said: "We know better who is there. We will verily, save him and his family - except his wife, she will be of those who remain behind."} 433. And when Our messengers came to Lut, he was grieved

487Surah 29. (31 - 35) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) he was grieved because of them , and felt straitened on their account. means, he was worried since if he had them as guests then he was afraid for them and what his people might do to them, but if he did not host them, he was still afraid of what might happen to them. At that point he did not know who they were. *jye- Vj Oiic *i/ ySj) 4*They said: "Have no fear, and do not grieve! Truly, we shall save you and your family except your wife: she will be of those who remain behind. Verily, we are about to bring down on the people of this town a great torment from the sky, because they have been rebellious."} Jibril, peace be upon him, uprooted their town from the depths of the earth, lifted it up to the sky, then threw it upside down upon them. Allah rained upon them: *Ji *d>j 4*stones of Sijjil, in a well-arranged manner one after another. Marked from your Lord; and they are not ever far from the evil doers.} [1 1:82-83] Allah turned the place where they had lived into a putrid, stinking lake, which will remain as a lesson to mankind until

the Day of Resurrection, and they will be among those who are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4353–4354]

most severely punished on the Day of Resurrection. Allah says: *4*And indeed We have left thereof an evident Ayah i.e., a clear sign, *4*for a folk who understand.} This is like the Ayah, ^Verily, you pass by them in the morning And at night; will m See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :82)

you not then reflect?} (37:137-138) *j (*J^*]yrJj iif bi4^ JUi tL^Li ^j»UJ rfe lj 4 {*&*-& *j»a£su ^TSy&A-i* cj^Vl 436.* And to Madyan, We sent their brother Shu'ayb. He said: "O my peop/e/ Worship Allah and hope for the last Day, and commit no mischief on the earth as mischief-makers."} 437. And they denied him; so the earthquake seized them, and they lay, prostrate in their dwellings .} Shu'ayb and His People Allah tells us that His servant and Messenger Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, warned his people, the people of Madyan, and commanded them to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate, and to fear the wrath and punishment of Allah on

the Day of Resurrection. He said:

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r-^ 40 my people! Worship Allah and hope for the last Day,} Ibn Jarir said: "Some of them said that this meant: Fear the Last Day."111 This is like the Ayah, !& ifoy ifor those who look forward to (meeting with) Allah and the Last Day} (60:6). *4S.-J— Jfjii > \ Vj} 4*and commit no mischief on the earth as

mischievous-makers.} This is forbidding them to make mischief on earth by spreading corruption, which means going around doing evil to people. They used to cheat in weights and measures, and ambush people on the road; this is in addition to their disbelief in Allah and His Messenger. So Allah destroyed them with a mighty earthquake that convulsed their land, and the Sayhah (shout) which tore their hearts from their bodies, and the torment of the Day of Shade, when their souls were taken. [il At-Tabari 20:34.

489 Surah 29. (36 - 40) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) ' i > _ .7> * * " X' o-^L)^t| LLA^==aL^Ii L / „y // "9y' { » ^ i » ^ U f -T / ' y'f' c/iljl* ^jSy4 » .i \$ _j A* |y /V «. •/" • -/ .f< y^#/ » ^ ^V o»~^-=z. ' .i>1 'ii^L)Ov-J ' > ol sggaigu ^This was the torment of a great day. We have already examined their story in detail in Surat Al- A'ra/, Surat Hud and Surat Ash-Shu'ard'. 4«nd f/iey lay, prostrate in their dwellings.) Qatadah said, "They were dead."*21 Others said that they were thrown on top of one another.*3' ^j6 aj fc£Sj &£J> O^*, -**' >4- iy^il—• iytij yC *V •/'" >" .•• 'CL>^> <!*>*£> cxxjif sj^>* jlaIj [yiT uj 4 232 jS^ C£.& CZ3 \$ rJi ui23^ i>^=. jGj ;&£) ft Uj& XM -J «2i2. 4:f:AE^ 438. And 'Ad and Thamud! And indeed (their destruction) is clearly apparent to you from their (ruined) dwellings. Shaytan made their deeds fair seeming to them, and turned them away 'o IB! Ski Cj*yij iifjU.^ —r ^ y *** Volume four, the Tafslr of Surat Al-A'raf (7:85), volume five, the

Tafsir of Surah Hud (11:84) , and volume seven , the Tafslr of Surat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4355–4361]

Ash-Shu'ard' (29 :36) At-Tabari 20:34 At-Tabari 20:34

from the path, though they were intelligent.} 439. And Qariin, Fir'awn, and Haman. And indeed Musa came to them with clear Aydt, but they were arrogant in the land, yet they could not outstrip Us.} 440. So, We punished each for his sins, of them were some on whom We sent a Hdsib, and of them were some who were overtaken by As-Sayhah, and of them were some whom We caused the earth to swallow, and of them were some whom We drowned. It was not Allah Wlw wronged them, but they wronged themselves.} The Destruction of Nations Who rejected Their Messengers Allah tells us about these nations who disbelieved in their Messengers, and how He destroyed them and sent various kinds of punishments and vengeance upon them. 'Ad, the people of Hud, peace be upon him, used to live in the Ahqaf (curved sand-hills), near Hadramawt, in the Yemen. Thamtd, the people of Salih, lived in Al-Hijr, near Wadi Al-Qura. The Arabs used to know their dwelling place very well, and they often used to pass by it. Qariin was the owner of great wealth and had the keys to immense treasures. Fir'awn, the king of Egypt at the time of Mdsa, and his minister Haman were two Copts who disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger, peace be upon him. 4**4* till y&} 4So, We punished each for his sins,} their punishments fit their crimes. & 1 *5^} iof them were some on whom We sent a Hdsib,} This was the case with 'Ad, and this happened because they said: "Who is stronger than us?" So, there came upon them a violent, intensely cold wind, which was very strong and carried pebbles which it threw upon them. It carried them through the air, lifting a man up to the sky and then hurling him headlong to the ground, so that his head split and he was left as a body without a head, like uprooted stems of date palms.

492Siirah 29. (38 - 40) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) and of them were some who were overtaken by As-Sayhah,} This is what happened to Thamtid, against whom evidence was established because of the she-camel who came forth when the rock was split, exactly as they had asked for. Yet despite that they did not believe, rather they persisted in their evil behavior and disbelief, and threatening to expel Allah's Prophet Salih and the believers with him, or to stone them. So the Sayhah struck them, taking away their powers of speech and movement. 4^~3'^ and of them were some whom We caused the earth to swallow,} This refers to Qarun who transgressed, he was evil and arrogant. He disobeyed his Lord, the Most High, and paraded through the land in a boastful manner, filled with self- admiration, thinking that he was better than others. He showed off as he walked, so Allah caused the earth to swallow him and his house, and he will continue sinking into it until

the Day of Resurrection. 40^ o and of them were some whom I've drowned.} This refers to Fir'awn, his minister Haman and their troops, all of whom were drowned in a single morning, not one of them escaped. i^4& 3 C,} It was not Allah Who wronged them,} in what He did to them, 4oy41" but they wronged themselves.} that happened to them as a punishment for what they did with their own hands. Ojj OJUit <Ji lijOcf dsdl ' oi ot L p~l> ill' o\ o \jV£=> OjJ

492 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 441 . The parable of those who seek protectors from other than Allah is that of a spider who builds a house; but indeed, the weakest of houses is the spider's house - if they but knew. 442. Verily, Allah knows what things they invoke instead of Him. He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.) 443. And these are the examples We give for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge (of Allah.) Likening the gods of the Idolators to the House of a Spider This is how Allah described the idolators in their reverence of gods besides Him, hoping that they would help them and provide for them, and turning to them in times of difficulties. In this regard, they were like the house of a spider, which is so weak and frail, because by clinging to these gods they were like a person who holds on to a spider's web, who does not gain any benefit from that. If they knew this, they would not take any protectors besides Allah. This is unlike the Muslim believer, whose heart is devoted to Allah, yet he still does righteous deeds and follows the Laws of Allah, for he has grasped the most trustworthy handle that will never break because it is so strong and firm. Then Allah warns those who worship others besides Him and associate others with Him that He knows what they do and the rivals they associate with Him. He will punish them for their attribution, for He is All-Wise and All-Knowing. Then He says: 4And these are the examples We give for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge.) meaning, no one understands them or ponders them except those who are possessed of deep knowledge. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Amr bin Murrah said, "I never came across an Ayah of the Book of Allah that I did not know, but it grieved me, because I heard that Allah says:

493Surah 29. (41- 45) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20 4And these are the examples We give for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge.}" 1^ ad) CrJ C 4 dl-1 & &-} & jTij ^ yk&t ^ ^jf^ 444. Allah created the heavens and the earth with truth. Verily, therein is surely a sign for those who believe.} 445. Recite what has been revealed to you of the Book, and perform the Salah. Verily, the Salah prevents from Al-Fahsha (immoral sins) and Al-Munkar (evil deeds) and the remembering (praising) of Allah is greater indeed. And Allah knows what you do.} Allah tells us of His

immense power, that He created the heavens and the earth with truth, meaning for a higher purpose than mere play, 4cs^ Of it that every person may be rewarded for that which he strives} (20:15). it that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with what is best} (53:31). vs 4 1\} iVerily, therein is surely a sign for those who believe.} meaning, there is clear evidence that Allah is alone in creating, controlling, and in His divinity. The Command to convey the Message, to recite the Qur'an and to pray Then Allah commands His Messenger and the believers to recite the Qur'an, which means both reciting it and conveying I 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim no. 17344 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :464

it to people. iZiJ& £35 C/cc, * - - - ykSJi perform the Salah. Verily, the Salah prevents from Al- Fahsha' and Al-Munkar and the remembrance of Allah is greater indeed.} Prayer includes two things: the first of which is giving up immoral behavior and evil deeds, i.e., praying regularly enables a person to give up these things. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: "A man came to the Prophet jg and said, 'So-and-so prays at night, but when morning comes, he steals.' The Prophet jg said: * >< + p aiJd tWluit you are saying (i.e., the Salah) will stop him from doing that.*™ Prayer also includes the remembering of Allah, which is the higher objective, Allah says: iand the remembrance of Allah is greater indeed.} more important than the former. < >1 c%%} 4And Allah knows what you do.} means, He knows all that you do and say. Abu Al-'Aliyah commented on the Ayah: jCs ;_jL <djf} 4Verily, the Salah prevents from immoral sins and evil wicked deeds} "Prayer has three attributes, and any prayer that contains none of these attributes is not truly prayer: Being done purely and sincerely for Allah alone (Ikhlas), fear of Allah, and remembrance of Allah. Ikhlas makes a person do good deeds, fear prevents him from doing evil deeds, and the remembrance of Allah is the Qur'an which contains commands and [i] Ahmad 2 :447

495Surah 29. (46) Al-'Ankabut (Part-21) prohibitions." ' Ibn 'Awn Al-Ansari said: "When you are praying, you are doing good, it is keeping you away from immoral sins and evil wicked deeds and what you are doing is part of the remembrance of Allah which is greater." ^^ Jt <£[4 t4\ &C Mk A ifa -h-J 446. And argue not with the People of the Scripture, except with that which is better - except with such of them as do wrong; and say (to them) : "We believe in that which has been revealed to us and revealed to you; our God and your God is One, and to Him we have submitted."} Arguing with the People of the Book

What is meant here is that anyone who wants to find out

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4361–4382]

about religion from them should argue with them in a manner that is better, as this will be more effective. Allah says: ilnvoke to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching...} (16:125) Ja &s!3m t-r T>. >' c > ly*. V) * *«. ' >-rg(rti U fa ;/ fes. / , Mil ^ ^^ 1 / - , Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this narration under this Ayah.

that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The People of the Book used to read the Tawrah in Hebrew and explain it in Arabic to the Muslims. The Messenger of Allah jg said: lllJ J 'J jilli lliT '.jijitj 'jj s. dSj ' l l 'si' 'jt * d •Do not believe the People of the Book and do not deny them. Say:

"We believe in Allah and what has been revealed to us and what has been revealed to you. Our God and your God is One, and to Him we have submitted."* This Hadith was narrated only by Al-Bukhari.111 Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: "How can you ask the People of the Book about anything, when your Book that was revealed to the Messenger of Allah is more recent, you read it pure and uncontaminated, it tells you that the People of the Book altered and changed the Book, that they write the Book with their own hands and then say, This is from Allah,' to purchase with it a small price? Should not the knowledge that you have, prevent you from asking them? No, by Allah, we have never seen any of them asking you about what was sent down to you."121 Al-Bukhari recorded that Humayd bin 'Abdur-Rahman heard Mu'awiyah talking to a group of Quraysh in Al-Madlnah. He mentioned Ka*b Al-Ahbar, and said: "He was one of the most truthful of those who narrated from the People of the Book, even though we found that some of what he said might be lies." I say, this means that some of what he said could be classified linguistically as lies, but he did not intend to lie, because he was narrating from manuscripts which he thought were good, but they contained fabricated material, because they did not have people who were so conscientious in memorizing the Scriptures by heart as the people of this great Ummah. 111 FathAl-Bdri8:20. 121 Al-Bukhari no . 7363

498 Tafsir Ibn Kathir fj**1 V> o! 'A4 ui !>i Cj 'y^o^i^all Vj ll^Ai Cy CJ 2y? &t <<>jf 4££ Sir. > j: fjS^f^5 6i vi, till teZ 447. And thus We have sent down the Book to you, and those whom We gave the Scripture believe therein as also do some of these and none but the disbelievers reject Our Ayat. 448. Neither did you read any book before it nor did you write any book with your right hand. In that case, indeed, the followers of falsehood might have doubted. 449. Nay, but it is clear Ayat, (preserved) in the breasts of those who have been given knowledge. And none but the wrongdoers deny Our Ayat Evidence for the fact that the Qur'an was revealed from Allah Ibn Jarir said: "Allah says, 'just as We revealed the Books to the Messengers who came before you, O Muhammad, so We have also revealed this Book to you.'" What he said is good and fits the context. Allah's saying: 4and those whom We gave the Scripture believe therein) means, those knowledgeable rabbis and scholars among them who learned it and recited it properly, such as 'Abdullah bin Salam, Salman Al-Farisi and others like them. 4fi>, ofc <y off) 4as also believe therein some of these) meaning, the Quraysh Arabs and others. vj Cj) 4and none but the disbelievers reject Our Ayat.) No one disbelieves and rejects them except those who conceal the truth with falsehood, and those who try to hide the rays m At-Tabari 20 :50.

499 Surah 29. (47 - 49) Al-Ankabut (Part-21) and light of the sun by their covering an eye. Then Allah says: Jt 1)^ iNeither did you read any book before it (this Qur'an) nor did you write any book with your right hand.} meaning, "you lived among your people for a long time before you brought this Qur'an. During this time you never read any book or wrote anything. Your people, as well as others all know that you are an unlettered man who does not read or write.' This is how he was also described in the previous Scriptures, as Allah says: JL '• 'it ' . ' 'tf >>>?' <4 (**•**"£ /Ojorf Jji' Jj-J' iThose who follow the Messenger, the Prophet, the unlettered about whom they find written with them in the Tawrah and the Injil, - he commands them with good; and forbids them from evil.} (7:157) This is how the Messenger of Allah will remain until the Day of Resurrection, unable to write even one line or one letter. He used to have scribes who would write down the revelation for him, or would write letters from him to be sent to different places. Allah's saying: iojh.In Cw 'H> }In that case, indeed, the followers of falsehood might have doubted.} means, *if you had been literate, some ignorant people would have

doubted you. They would have said that you learned this from Books inherited from the Prophets which came before.’ Indeed, they did say that, even though they knew that he was unlettered and could not read or write. }And they say : "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} (25:5)

500 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah says: puu (JJil iSay : “It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth} (25:6). And Allah says here: / w { 4'Ui tjj iNay, but it is (Quran), the clear Aydt, (preserved) in the breasts of those who have been given knowledge.} meaning, this Qur'an is clear Aydt which indicate the truth, commands, prohibitions and stories. It is memorized by the scholars forwhom Allah makes it easy to memorize, recite and interpret. This is like the Ayah, c* J5 JM €2 ^j} iAnd We have indeed made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any one who zoill remember?} (54:17). The Messenger of Allah jg said: &-j ILjff ^jji otf dtj dL j* u JJ.I jJj N)^ l «UL15 bjS\M Sll *There has never been any Prophet who was not given that which would make people believe in him. What I have been given is revelation which Allah reveals to me, and I hope that I will have the mostfollowers among them .b*1 According to the Hadith of Iyad bin Himar, recorded in Sabah Muslim, Allah says: UiU Vyji iJUJi iLjj i cys JjQp Jji Jjl. iuip J\> «"/ am testing you and testing others through you, revealing to you a Book which cannot be washed away by water, which you recite while you are asleep and while you are awake. This means, if the manuscript where it is written were to be washed with water, there is no need for that manuscript. 111 Fath Al-Bari8:619. Muslim 4:2197.

This is because it is preserved in the hearts and is easy on the tongue (i.e., is easy to recite), and is controlling people's hearts and minds. It is miraculous in its wording and in its meanings. In the previous Scriptures this Ummah was described as carrying their holy Books in their hearts. 4And none but the wrongdoers deny Our Ayat} Nobody denies it or tries to undermine its status or rejects it except the wrongdoers, i.e., the arrogant transgressors who know the truth but turn away from it, as Allah says: !££# <£= j& iTruly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) S& if i* iLfs a.t ji %£ £ iS V 4 fO £>' 450. And they say: "Why are not signs sent down to himfrom his Lord?" Say: "The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a plain wamer."} 451. Is it not sufficient for them that We have sent down to you the Book which is recited to them? Verily, herein is mercy and a reminderfor a people who believe.} 452. Say: “Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. He knows what is in the heavens and on the earth." And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers.} The Idolaters’ demand for Signs, and the Response Allah tells us how the idolaters stubbornly demanded signs, meaning that they wanted signs to show them that Muhammad was indeed the Messenger of Allah, just as

^i! L#a^ tit ils it not sufficientfor them that We have sent down to you the Book which is recited to them?} means, “is it not sufficient as a sign for them that We have sent down to you this great Book which tells them about what happened before their time, what will happen after they are gone, and passes judgement between them. Even though you are an unlettered man who can neither read nor write, and you have not mixed with any of the People of the Book. Yet you brought them news of what was said in the first Scriptures showing what is right in the matters that they dispute over, and bringing clear and obvious truth.’ As Allah says: j& (d& ft} 41\$ it not a sign to them that the learned scholars of

the Children of Israel knew it (to be true)?} (26:197) wjuwJt 4 £ ii- p-cf (<y '4i oi YjJ 4They say : "Why does he not bring us a sign from his Lord?" Has there not come to them the proof of that which is in the former Scriptures?} (20:133) Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: dp & jS& u 9^1 & £i\ as Ni ii^ # Ub jl y>-jli i£lj 4)i u-j cjj ^Jji ji5 uThere is no Prophet who was not given some miracles that would make the people believe in him. What I have been given is revelation which Allah reveals to me, and I hope that I will have the greatest number of followers on the Day of Resurrection .a"*11 It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.121 Indeed Allah has said: 111 Ahmad 2:341. 121 FathAl-B6ri 8:619, Muslim 1:134.

&£=>}j -^4'i j 4Verily, herein is mercy and a reminder for a people who believe. In this Qur'an there is mercy, that is, explanation of the truth and removal of falsehood, and a reminder to the believers of the punishment that is to come to the disbelievers and sinners. Then Allah says: 4Say: "Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you..."} 'He knows best the words of denial that you utter, and he knows what I am telling you about Him and that He has sent me. If I were telling lies about Him, He would have executed His vengeance upon me,' as Allah says elsewhere: it £» a s* c&i p 14 e 4And ifhe had forged a false saying concerning Us, We surely would have seized him by his right hand, and then We certainly would have cut off his aorta, and none of you could have withheld Usfrom (punishing) him.} (69:44-47). *But I am telling the truth in what I say to you about Him, so He has supported me with clear miracles and definitive evidence.' 4He knows what is in the heavens and the earth.} means, nothing is hidden from Him at all. 4And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers.} means, on the Day of Resurrection, they will be punished for what they did, and will get what they justly deserve for rejecting the truth and following falsehood, for disbelieving in the Messengers of Allah even when there was proof that they

454. They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily. Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers.} 455. On the Day when the torment shall cover them from above them andfrom beneath theirfeet, and it will be said: "Taste what you used to do."} Howthe Idolatorsasked for theTorment tobe hastened on Allah tells us of the ignorance of the idolators and how they asked for the punishment of Allah to be hastened so that it would befall them quickly. This is like the Ayah, IL& JJ4 JU i 53 * ui 4 JUJSi

507Surah 29. (56 - 60) Al-'Ankabiit (Part-21 ilf only those who disbelieved knew (the time) when they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, norfrom their backs (21:39). The Fire will cover them from all sides, which is more effective as a physical punishment. £ 1 Jj£j} iand it will be said: "Taste what you used to do."} This is a threat and a rebuke, which is a form of psychological punishment, as in the Ayah, It* 'Jj* 4 *>#*•> pi; iThe Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire (it will be said to them) : "Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with a measurement.} (54:48-49) .ii j£ J', &} **' ' Oi 45 V i V\$ f ;i iThe Day whei\ they will be pushed down byforce to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. This is the Fire which you used to deny. Is this magic or do you not see? Enter you therein (taste you therein its heat) and whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requitedfor what you used to do.} (52:13-16) *4} f vP* ur" y ipj 61 ipC Zdi f£*£} iff Cb a* (4 [APj IP* jM) y >*•> o£ C/j^=U pt\} ifj \isf> OjJ' Pi fu oyti- <56. O My servants who believe! Certainly, spacious is My earth. Therefore

worship Me.} 457. Everyone shall taste death. Then unto Us you shall be returned.} 458. And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, to them We shall surely give lofty dwellings in Paradise, beneath

We shall surely give lofty dwellings in Paradise, underneath which rivers flow,} meaning, *We shall cause them to dwell in lofty homes in Paradise under which various kinds of rivers flow - water, wine, honey and milk - which they can direct and cause to flow wherever they wish.' }to live therein forever.} means, they will remain there forever, never wanting to leave. ^ ^IU.} 4Excellent is the reward for the workers.} these rooms will be a blessed reward for the good deeds of the believers, iThose who are patient,} in adhering to their religion, who migrated for the sake of Allah and fought the enemy, leaving behind their families and relatives to seek Allah's Face, and hoping for that which is with Him, believing His promise. Ibn Abi Hatim, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded from Abu Mu'aniq Al-Ash'ari that Abu Malik Al-Ash'ari told him that the Messenger of Allah jgj told him: ^)l I UjAUJ {jA 1^4 kill'll Ij* o[B «fG «/« Paradise there are rooms whose outside can be seen from the inside, and their inside can be seen from the outside; Allah has prepared them for those who feed others, who speak well, who pray and fast continually, and who stand in prayer at night while people are asleep .i &j} iand put their trust in their Lord.} W At-Tabarfini 17:372

They will surely reply: "Allah." How then are they deviating?} <\$62. Allah expands the provision for whom He wills of His servants, and straitens it for whom (He wills). Ve- rily, Allah is the All- Knower of everything.} 463. And if you were to ask them : "Who sends down water from the sky, and gives life there- with to the earth after its death?" They will surely reply: "Allah." Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah!" Nay, most of them have no sense.} Evidences of Tawhîd Allah states that there is no God but He. The idolators who worshipped others besides Him recognized that He was the sole creator of the heavens and earth, the sun and the moon, alternating the night and day. They acknowledged that He was the Creator Who provided for His servants and decreed how long they should live. He made them and their provision different, so that some were rich and some were poor, and He knew best what was suitable for each of them, who deserved to be rich and who deserved to be poor. So, Allah stated that He has alone created everything, and that He alone is controlling them - if this is how it is, then why worship anyone else? Why put one's trust in anyone else? Since dominion is His Alone, then let worship be for Him Alone. Allah often establishes His divinity by referring to their acknowledgement of His Unique Lordship, because the idolators used to acknowledge His t • t mamw » A, it ' 'j1 Uli<ju5U ililUl 1

This is like the Ayah, 2'f ji V) ojp-ji & Ji j fjll' 4And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him (Allah Alone). But when He brings you safely to land, you turn away^ (17:67). Allah says here: 4but when He brings them safely to land, behold, they give a share of their worship to others. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from 'Ikrimah bin Abi Jahl that when the Messenger of Allah conquered Makkah, he (Ikrimah) ran away, fleeing from him. When he was on the sea, headed for Ethiopia, the ship started to rock and the crew said: "O people, pray sincerely to your Lord alone, for no one can save us from this except Him." 'Ikrimah said: "By Allah, if there is none who can save us on the sea except Him, then there is none who can save us on land except Him either, O Allah, I vow to You that if I come out of this, I will go and put my hand in the hand of Muhammad

and I will find him kind and merciful.” And this is what indeed did happen. iSo that they become ingrate for that which We have given them, and that they take their enjoyment,} f&f- q Q & c£/*' if-t jUW !>y Sil i}j U£i Lj 467. Have they not seen that We have made a secure sanctuary, while men are being snatched away from all around than ? Then do they believe in falsehood, and deny the graces of Allah?} 468. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him? Is IM At-Tabarani 3 :301

there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?} i69. /Is for those who strive hard for Us, We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.} The Blessing of the Sanctuary Here Allah reminds Quraysh how He blessed them by granting them access to His sanctuary which He has made (open) to (all) men, the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there, and whoever enters it is safe, because he is in a place of great security, although the Arabs of the desert round about used to ambush and raid one another and kill one another. As Allah says: grj*- oi ojlfi For the protection of the Quraysh. The caravans to set forth safe in winter and in summer. So let them worship the Lord of this House. Who has fed them against hunger, and has made them safe from fear.} (106:1-4) 4Then do they believe in falsehood, and deny the graces of Allah?} means, is the thanks that they give for this immense blessing to associate others with Him and worship others besides Him, idols and rivals? iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} (14:28) They disbelieved in the Prophet, servant and Messenger of Allah 5^, when what they should have done was to worship Allah Alone and not associate anything with Him, and to believe in, honor and respect the Messenger, but they rejected him and fought him, and expelled him from their midst. So, Allah took His blessing away from them, and killed those of

them whom He killed at Badr, then His Messenger sg and the believers gained the upper hand, and Allah enabled His Messenger 2g to conquer Makkah, and He disgraced them and humiliated them (the disbelievers). Then Allah says: 4t3»L- CJ ^ 4And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him?} There is no one who will be more severely punished than one who tells lies about Allah and says that Allah revealed something to him at the time when Allah did not reveal anything to him, or says, *1 shall reveal something like that which Allah revealed.’ And there is no one who will be more severely punished than one who denies the truth when it comes to him, for the former is a fabricator and the latter is a disbeliever. Allah says: & '(4* j 41s there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?} Then Allah says: \jx&. &\$} 4As for those who strive hard for Us,} meaning the Messenger jg and his Companions and those who follow him, until the Day of Resurrection, 4We will surely guide them to Our paths.} means, “We will help them to follow Our path in this world and the Hereafter.’ Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that ‘Abbas Al-Hamdani Abu Ahmad - one of the people of ‘Akka (Palestine) - said, concerning the Ayah: 4As for those who strive hard for Us (in Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.}

“Those who act upon what they know, Allah will guide them to that which they do not know.” Ahmad bin Abu Al-Hawari said, “I told this to Abu Sulayman Ad-Darani, and he liked it and said: ‘No one who is inspired to do something good should do it until he hears a report concerning that; if he hears a report then he should go ahead and do it, and praise Allah because it was in accordance with what he himself

felt.”” Sill iAnd verily, Allah is with the doers of good.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ash-Sha*bi said; “Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, said: ‘Righteousness means doing good to those who ill- treat you, it does not mean doing good to those who do good to you.’ ”And Allah knows best.

Surah 30: Ar-Rum

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4383–4421]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Ar-Rum (Chapter - 30) Which was revealed in Makkah P 3 In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. *r'a y@p#S ASK 4J»I YL'jy-j^ '-^fr A&s ^0 3r ui(4Jo^-iplS0 gS0 AA * *f -J ISj0^^ Aj &3J YAj 2(4ft V Jf 0^j£ o;CJ> j* Gif)i£ & £^ 42= A L*r3' 6 41 . AlifLam Mvm .)* 42. *TTi£* Romans have been defeated. 43. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious.) 44. In Bid'i years. The decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah. And on that day, the believers will rejoice) With the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.) *jk o£ k. u 35 « j-ftf a > :>;f >" t' •. v' &s*

46. A promise from Allah, and Allah fails not in His promise, but most men know not.} 47. They know only the outer appearance of the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} Foretelling the Victory of the Romans These Ayat were revealed about the victory of Sabdr, the king of Persia, over Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), the adjoining partisan states of the Arabian Peninsula, and the outlying regions of the land of the Romans. Heraclius, the emperor of the Romans, was forced to flee to Constantinople where he was besieged for a lengthy period. Then Heraclius regained the upper hand. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on this Ayah 4 AlifLam Mim. The Romans have been defeated. In the nearest land,} He said, "They were defeated and then they were victorious." He said, "The idolators wanted the Persians to prevail over the Romans, because they were idol worshippers, and the Muslims wanted the Romans to prevail over the Persians, because they were People of the Book. This was mentioned to Abu Bakr, who mentioned it to the Messenger of Allah The Messenger of Allah SI said: *tThey will certainly prevail .»* Abu Bakr mentioned this to the idolators, and they said, "Set a time limit for that, and if we prevail, we will get such and such; and if you prevail, you will get such and such." So he set a limit of five years, and they (the Romans) did not prevail. Abu Bakr mentioned that to the Messenger of Allah *jk* and he said: *«-jliJl : Jli Wj\ - l)/> Jl aPWiy* do you not make it less than» (I (the narrator) think he meant less than ten]. Satd bin Jubayr said: *uBid'* means less than ten." Then the Romans

were victorious, and he said, "That is what Allah said: *40SJ&Z U&A oj piJjM ti *2 dll' ©ojLjji!' Q-ii il Oi> Oi J-A''' ^ iAlifLam Mim.* The Romans have been defeated. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious. In Bid'i years. The decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah. And on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All- Mighty, the Most Merciful.} *ll]* This was also recorded by At-Tirxnidhi and An-Nasal. At-Tirmidhi said: "Hasan Gharib."*2 Another Hadith Abu isa At-Tirmidhi recorded that Niyar bin Mukram Al- Aslami said: "When the following Ayat were revealed: *e?» ^ 0£ 'U : iAlifLam Mim.* The Romans

have been defeated. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious. In Bid' years.} on the day they were revealed, the Persians were prevailing over the Romans. The Muslims wanted the Romans to prevail over them (the Persians), because they were both people who followed a Book. Concerning this Allah said: >> r © iAnd on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} The Quraysh, on the other hand, wanted the Persians to 111 Ahmad 1 :276. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9:51, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :426

prevail, because neither of them were people who followed a Book and neither of them believed in the Resurrection. When Allah revealed these Ayat, Abu Bakr went out proclaiming throughout Makkah: - **4 oi (**j ofjVf J'J ti iAlifLam Mim. The Romans have been defeated. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious. In Bid' years Some of the Quraysh said to Abu Bakr: This is (a bet) between us and you. Your companion claims that the Romans will defeat the Persians within three to nine years, so why not have a bet on that between us and you?' Abu Bakr said, *Yes.' This was before betting had been forbidden. So, Abu Bakr and the idolators made a bet, and they said to Abu Bakr: What do you think, Bid' means something between three and nine years, so let us agree on the middle.' So they agreed on six years. Then six years passed without the Romans being victorious, so the idolators took what they had bet with Abu Bakr. When the seventh year came and the Romans were finally victorious over the Persians, the Muslims rebuked Abu Bakr for agreeing on six years. He said: 'Because Allah said: "In Bid' years."' At that time, many people became Muslim." This is how it was narrated by At-Tirmidhi, then he said, "This is a Hasan Hadith ."11 Who were the Romans? iAlifLam Mim. The Romans have been defeated.} We have already discussed the separate letters which appear at the beginning of some Surahs in the beginning of our Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. With regard to the Romans (Ar-Rum), they are the descendents of Al-lys bin Ishaq bin Ibrahim. They are the cousins of the Children of Israll, and are also known as Bani m TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :52.

522Surah 30. Ar-Rum (1 - 7) (Part-21 Al-Asfar. They used to followed the religion of the Greeks, who were descendents of Yafith bin Nuh, the cousins of the Turks. They used to worship the seven planets, and they prayed facing the direction of the North Pole. It is they who founded Damascus and built its temple in which there is a prayer niche facing north. The Romans followed this religion until approximately three hundred years after the time of the Messiah. The king who ruled Greater Syria along with the Fertile Crescent (semicircle of fertile land from Syrian Desert to Persian Gulf) was called Caesar. The first of them to enter the Christian religion was Constantine the son of Costas, whose mother was Maryam Al-Hllaniyyah Ash-Shadqaniyyah, from the land of Harran. She had become Christian before him, and she invited him to her religion. Before that he had been a philosopher, then he followed her. It was said that this was merely an outward show of belief. Then the Christians met with him. During his time they debated with 'Abdullah bin Ariyus (Arius) and great differences arose which could not be reconciled. Then a gathering of three hundred and eighteen bishops reached an agreement, and presented their creed to Constantine. This is what they call the Great Trust, but in fact it is the Worst Betrayal. They presented to him their laws, i.e., books of rulings on what was lawful and prohibited, and other things that they needed. They changed the religion of the Messiah (peace be upon him), adding some things and taking some things away. They began praying towards the East, and changed the Sabbath (Saturday) rites to Sunday. They worshipped the cross, permitted eating of pigs, adopted innovated observances such as the festival of the cross, Mass, baptism, etc., Palm Sunday and

other occasions. They appointed a pope, as their leader, and patriarchs, metropolitans, bishops, priests and deacons, and they invented monasticism. The king built churches and places of worship for them, and he founded the city which is named after him, Constantinople. It was said that during his time twelve thousand churches were built, three places of prayer in Bethlehem, and that his mother built the Church of the Holy Sepulchre. These are the ones who followed the religion of the kings. Then after them came the Jacobites, followers of Ya'qub Al-

522 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Askaf, then the Nestorians, the followers of Nestorius. There are many groups and sects among them, as the Messenger of Allah said: ***jt Or- f-fr'l *They split into seventy two sects. The point here is that they continued to follow Christianity. Every time one Caesar died, another succeeded him, until the last of them, Heraclius, came to power. He was a wise man, one of the most astute and intelligent of kings, who had deep insight and well-formed opinions. His was a great and glorious reign. He was opposed by Chosroes, the king of Persia and of regions such as Iraq, Khurasan, Ar-Riy and all the lands of the Persians. His name was SabQr Dhul-Aktaf, and his kingdom was greater than the kingdom of Caesar. He was the leader of the Persians and was as stubborn as the Persians who were Zoroastrian fire worshippers. How Caesar defeated Chosroes (Kisra) It was previously reported that Tkrimah said: "Chosroes sent his deputy and his army against Caesar, and they fought." It is well-known that Chosroes himself fought in the army that invaded his land, and he defeated Caesar and overwhelmed him until he had nothing left except the city of Constantinople, where Chosroes besieged him for a long time, until things became very difficult for him. He was highly venerated among the Christians, and Chosroes was not able to conquer the city because it was well fortified, and half of it faced the land while the other half faced the sea, from where supplies were able to reach them. After this had gone on for a long time, Caesar thought of a clever trick. He asked Chosroes to let him leave his city in return for money given as a peace- offering, on whatever terms he (Chosroes) wanted. Chosroes agreed to that and asked for a huge amount of wealth - gold, jewels, fabric, servant-women, servants, and much more - such that no king on earth could ever pay. Caesar went along with that and gave him the impression that he had all that he had asked for, although he thought he was crazy for asking for such a thing, because even if the two of them were to combine all of their wealth, it would not amount to even one-

523 Surah 30. Ar-Rum (1 - 7) (Part-21 tenth of that. He asked Chosroes to let him go out of the city to Ash-Sham and the other regions of his kingdom, so that he could gather that from his storehouses and places where his wealth was buried. Chosroes let him go, and when Caesar was about to leave Constantinople, he gathered his people together and told them: "I am going out on a mission I have decided to do so with some soldiers I have selected from my army; if I come back to you before one year passes, I will still be your king but if I do not come back after that, you will have the choice. Then, if you wish, you may remain loyal to me, or if you wish you may appoint someone instead of me." They replied, "You are our king for as long as you live, even if you are gone for ten years." When he left Constantinople, a cavalry detachment left with him, and Chosroes camped outside Constantinople to await his return. Caesar went straight away to the land of the Persians, where he started to kill all the men of fighting age, one by one, and he did not stop killing until he reached Al- Madain, which was the seat of power of the kingdom of Chosroes. He killed everyone in the city, and took all its treasures and wealth. He captured the women of Chosroes, shaved his son's head and made him ride on his donkey,

sending with him the leaders of his people in a state of utmost humiliation. He wrote to Chosroes saying, 'This is what you asked for, so take it.' When this reached Chosroes, he was extremely distressed, to an extent known only by Allah. His anger was directed against the city of Constantinople and he renewed his siege with increased vehemence, but he was not able to besiege it for long, nor was he able to go to the ford of the river Jayhan, which was the only route through which Caesar could reach Constantinople. When Caesar heard of this, he came up with an unprecedented strategy, whereby he left his troops and goods by the ford, and went off with some of his army. He commanded them to pick up some straw and animal droppings, and to travel approximately one day upstream. Then he told them to throw those things unto the water. When they passed by Chosroes, he and his soldiers thought that the Romans had gone that way, so they rode off in pursuit of them, and the ford was no longer occupied by the Persians. Then Caesar commanded his men to get up and

524 TafsTr Ibn Kathlr jump into the river, which they did, thus escaping Chosroes and his troops, then they entered Constantinople. That was a great day for the Christians. Chosroes and his army remained in a state of confusion, not knowing what they were doing. They had not been able to conquer the land of Caesar, and their own land was devastated by the Romans, who seized their wealth, and captured their women and children. This was how the Romans defeated the Persians, and this happened nine years after the Persians defeated the Romans. This conflict between the Persians and the Romans continued until the Romans prevailed between Adhru'at (Ash-Sham) and Busrfi, according to what was stated by Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah and others. This is a place on the edge of Ash-Shfim, along the border with Al-Hijaz. Mujahid said, "That was a place in the Arabian Peninsula which is closer to the land of the Romans than to Persia." And Allah knows best. jf* *t' > -Iff i v T-M on Jr* Oi Af iThe decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah before that and after that. iAnd on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah> They will rejoice because the Romans, the companions of Caesar, the king of Ash-Sham, defeated the Persians, the companions of Chosroes, who were Zoroastrians. According to many of the scholars, such as Ibn 'Abbas, Ath-Thawri, As-Suddl and others, the victory of the Romans over the Persians happened on the same day as the battle of Badr. It was reported in the Hadith recorded by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Jarir, Ibn Abi Hatim and Al-Bazzar that Abu Said said: "On the day of Badr, the Romans defeated the Persians, and the believers were happy and rejoiced about that. And Allah revealed the words: />/ 'if is

4And on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.y*1 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Az-Zubayr Al-Kilabi said, "I saw the victory of the Persians over the Romans, then I saw the victory of the Romans over the Persians, then I saw the victory of the Muslims over both the Persian and the Romans, and all of that happened within fifteen years." Allah's saying: {and He is the All-Mighty,} means, in His defeat of and vengeance upon His enemies. His saying: 4the Most Merciful.} means, towards His believing servants. i*' ^ ^j} 4(It is) a promise of Allah, and Allah fails not in His promise.} means, *this that We have told you, O Muhammad, that the Romans will defeat the Persians, is a true promise from Allah, truth which cannot be changed and which will surely come to pass, because Allah has decreed that the one of the two parties that is closer to the truth will prevail and that victory will be theirs.' 2*1& ibut most men know not.} means, they do not know the decree of Allah concerning His creation, but what He does is wise and is based on justice. His saying: Cf Ityp ot i 0*^*1T iThey know only the outer appearance of

the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} means, most people know only about this world and how to make a living and so on. They are clever when it comes to TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :50 , At-Tabari 20 :73

getting what they need and earning a living, but they are heedless of that which will benefit them in the Hereafter; they are unaware of it and have no idea about it. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "It has reached the state that in this world one of them could put a Dirham on his finger and tell how much it weighs, but he does not know how to pray properly." / i/*\$? y® ik oJ&} iThexj know only the outer appearance of the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means that the disbelievers know how to prosper in this world, but they are ignorant of matters of religion."*11 l**— J~t> Ji&b vS^ 1 ? jji. l; jtj-jil i) jtT uftS"? 4 itij-j ij? oj_J u*M J#? 53 •*£ « Si? a# 2 ,44^ Si? Q ,4iij _'S 'jj*>i~i ^ iySj <i? c4i< o* j<jSl 4S. Do they not reflect on themselves? Allah has created not the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, except with truth and for an appointed term. And indeed many of mankind deny meeting with their Lord.} \$9. Do they not travel in the land, and see what was the end of those before them? They were superior to them in strength, and they tilled the earth and populated it in greater numbers than these have done, and there came to them their Messengers with clear proofs. Surely, Allah wronged them not, but they used to wrong themselves.} 410. Then evil was the end of those who did evil, because they denied theAyat ofAllah and made a mockery ofthem.} Signs of Tawhid Allah tells us that pondering His creation will show that He m At-Tabari 20:76.

527Surah 30. Ar-Rum (8 - 10) (Part-21) exists and that He is Unique in creating it, and that there is no god nor lord besides Him. So He says: tj)&£ fi} iDo they not reflect upon themselves?} Thinking and pondering how Allah created various things in the upper and lower realms and in the space between, realizing that this was not created in jest or in vain, but in truth, and that it will continue until an appointed time, the Day of Resurrection, as Allah says: 44 rfi! Si Uf} iAnd indeed many ofmankind deny meeting with their Lord.} Then Allah tells us of the truth of the Message brought by the Messengers and how He supported them with miracles and clear signs, such as when He destroyed those who disbelieved in them and saved those who believed in them. j, iDo they not travel in the land?} means, 'do they not understand and think and see and hear about the people of the past?' Allah says: B jr)f&} iand see what was the end of those before them? They were superior to them in strength,} meaning, 'the nations of the past who came before you were stronger than you to whom Muhammad^ has been sent; they had more wealth and more sons. You have not been given one-tenth of what they were given. They stayed longer in this world than you will stay. They were more civilized than you and were more prosperous in the land than you.' Yet despite all that, when their Messengers came to them with clear signs, while they were enjoying their life of luxury, Allah punished them for their sins and they had no one who could protect them from Allah. Their wealth and sons could not protect them from the wrath of Allah in the slightest, and Allah was not at all unjust towards them when He sent His punishment upon them.

530 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr Allah said: 4'.LZ f jffi 4Allah originates the creation, then He will repeat it,\$ Just as He was able to create it in the first place, so He is also able to repeat it. t s' tow ithen to Him you will be returned on the Day of Resurrection, when each will be requited according to his deeds. Then Allah says: iAnd on the Day when the Hour will be established, the criminals will be plunged into destruction

with despair. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The sinners will be filled with despair.” Mujahid said, “The sinners will be exposed;” according to another report he said, “The sinners will grieve.”⁰¹ 4No intercessors will they have from those whom they made equal with Allah, means, the gods whom they used to worship instead of Allah will not intercede for them; they will reject them and betray them despite their desperate need of them. Then Allah says: ^ >*C 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated. Qatadah said: “By Allah, this refers to the separation after which there will be no reunion.”^{*2} * In other words, if one person is taken up to the highest heights and another is sent down to the lowest depths of Hell, that is the last they will ever see of one another. Allah says: a£li \pC tty iThen as for those who believed and did righteous good deeds, At-Tabari 20:80. At-Tabari 20:81.

531Surah 30. Ar-Rum (17-19) (Part-21) such shall be honored and made to enjoy a luxurious life in a Garden of Delight .} Mujahid and Qatadah said, “This means, they will enjoy a life of luxury.” L *,gj aJj tj**) y "•iff ^ *{' ' > •>/ .I' / Z"?? > '* #rvTi*-' > »’•* - •>’ -Uu J*j?\\ CwJ' ot if*' v,£ioirfJ« JW> 417. So glorify Allah, when you enter the evening, and when you enter the morning. 418. And His is all the praise in the heavens and the earth; and in ‘Ashiyya and when Tuzhiriin.} 419. He brings out the living from the dead, and brings out the dead from the living. And He revives the earth after its death. And thus shall you be brought out.} TheCommand to pray FiveTimes Daily Here Allah glorifies Himself and commands His servants to glorify and praise Him at these times which come one after the other and are indicative of His might and power in the heavens. This is when the night comes with its darkness, then in the morning the day comes with its light. This glorification is followed by befitting praise, as Allah says: 4And His is all the praise in the heavens and the earth;} meaning, He is the One who is to be praised for what He has created in the heavens and on earth. Then Allah says: Jifj &*>} 4and in ‘Ashiyya and when Tuzhiriin.} - the ‘Ashiyy is the time when the darkness is most intense, and Izhar is the brightest point of the day. Glory be to the OneWho created both ofthem, the Cleaver of the daybreak and the One Who makes night a time of rest. Allah says: m At-Tabari 20 :82

4And you see the earth barren, but when We send down water on it, it is stirred, and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind.} until: 4and certainly, Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.} (22:5-7) 4M Jil%£3# ii: \\Uj. <\$And if is He Who sends the winds as heralds ofglad tidings, going before His mercy. Till when they have carried a heavy- laden cloud} until: iso that you may remember or take heed.} (7:57) Allah says here: 4And thus shall you be brought out.} 3E. 3 2 ytf oj pSi 3 M j \\ ip^ £ j3 «0*^' *2 420. And among His signs is this that He created you from dust, and then - behold you are human beings scattered!} 421. And among His signs is this that He created Jbr you wives from among yourselves, that you may find repose in them, and He has put between you affection and mercy. Verily, in that are indeed signsfor a people who reflect.} Among the Signs ofAllah Allah says: 4And among His signs} - which speak of His might and power, is the fact that He created your fatherAdam out of dust. &%%}

535Surah 30. Ar-Rum (22 - 23) (Part-21 Allah said: ^ jji. J 4And among His signs is this that He created for you wives from among yourselves,} meaning, *He created females ofyourown kind, to be wives foryou.’ 4that you mayfind repose in them,} This is like the Ayah, <3--w j-VI> w?" oi 411 is He Who has created you from a single person, and He has createdfrom him his wife, in order that he might enjoy

the pleasure of living with her} (7:189). This refers to Hawwa'. Allah created her from Adam, from the short rib on his left. If Allah had made all of Adam's progeny male, and created the females from another kind, such as from Jinn or animals, there would never have been harmony between them and their spouses. There would have been revulsion if the spouses had been from a different kind. Out of Allah's perfect mercy He made their wives from their own kind, and created love and kindness between them. For a man stays with a woman because he loves her, or because he feels compassion towards her if they have a child together, or because she needs him to take care of her, etc. 4<jjf2& /\$, ail'i 4 d[} 4Verily, in that are indeed signs for a people who reflect.} yJ 'i'h tj 5) <-*&•{) Jti- -ij4 422 . And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the difference of your languages and colors. Verily, in that are indeed signs for men of sound knowledge.} 423 . And among His signs is your sleep by night and by day, and your seeking His bounty. Verily, in that are indeed signs for a people who listen.}

Allah said: Kf} AAnd. among His signs} indicating His magnificent power. iofM &*} \$is the creation of the heavens and the earth,} The heavens with their vast height and brightness and beauty of the stars and planets, and the earth with its density and its mountains, valleys, seas, plains, animals and trees. iand the difference of your languages} So, we see that some speak Arabic, and the Tatars have their own language, as do the Georgians, Romans, Franks, Berbers, Tou Couleurs (of Sudan), Ethiopians, Indians, Persians, Slavs, Khazars, Armenians, Kurds and others. Only Allah knows the variety of languages spoken among the sons of Adam. And the difference of their colors mentioned here refers to their appearance, for all the people of this world, from the time that Allah created Adam, and until the Hour begins, each of them has two eyes, two eyebrows, a nose, a forehead, a mouth and two cheeks, but none of them looks like another; there is bound to be some difference in posture, appearance and speech, whether it is apparent or is hidden and can only be noticed with careful observation. Each face has its own characteristics and does not look like another; even if there was a group of people who looked alike, having a beautiful or ugly characteristic in common, there would still be a difference between one person and the next. 4Verily, in that are indeed signs far men of sound knowledge.} .f' wb J IfS} 4And among His signs is your sleep by night and by day, and your seeking of His bounty.} Among His signs is the cycle of sleep that He has created during the night and the day, when people are able to cease moving and rest, so that their tiredness and exhaustion will go

537Surah 30. Ar-Rum (24 - 25) (Part-21 jn>. t<v iL-l! z4i^U <3^»J ^ \j-C>_c£jj J^=c^jVij v > *y »" / *V> « **> / ^>y - »< Up <IUIXi== r/ // i<* * > ^'J ""* *->""1 ^ ^ >» *_ • yJill jLUJ ^it ^ upLuV E^P^away. And He has enabled you to seek to earn a living and to travel about during the day, this is the opposite of sleep. -f.A J\$ ^4 O^ /- >'• \$Verily, in that are indeed signs far a people who listen.} meaning, understand. ^=*y. •£&* jtj} & \$z& « a>j££ 6> ^3i *4? JjJ'i 4 <£l jyij j CAJ l>J -,»a\ J>jilj «CJi ^ c£>Vi ' >>:- 424. And among His signs is that He shows you the lightning, far fear and far hope, and He sends down water from the sky, and therewith revives the earth after its death. Verily, in that are indeed signs far a people who understand> 425. And among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command. Then afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth.} Allah says, &>} 4And among His signs} which speak of His greatness, 4^—^'j tjji- !*£=»->/_ 4He shows you the lightning, far fear and far hope,}

dead will come forth from their graves, brought back to life by His command and His call to them, 4*
 - • 4 »"• Jf " > />>>/ v 477ien afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come
 outfrom the earth.} This is like the Ayat. > »v> •<- (j;;> }On the Day when He will call you, and you
 will answer with His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed but a little while!}
 (17:52) iBut it will be only a single ZajrahP1 When behold, they find themselves on the surface of the
 earth alive after their death.} (79:13-14), and 4 L-i-d 1JU.j .-z\£— ilt will be but a single SayhahJ21 so
 behold they will all be brought up before Us!} (36:53). ^ 'J-V. jk) » Jd J^=> oylli' j ,y > /-'tf > '•.f <*- K'
 c ^ 426. To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. All are obedient to Him.} 427. And
 He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him. His is the highest
 description in the heavens and in the earth. And He is the All- Mighty, the All-Wise.} Allah says: *
 ±*%} 4To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth.} means, He owns it and it is enslaved
 to Him. See the Tafsrof Surat As-Saff&t (37 : 19| * See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (11 :94)

540 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr i'n iAll are obedient to Him.} they are humble before Him and submit to Him,
 whether willingly or unwillingly. Repeatingthe Creation is easier forAllah Allah's saying: / * f* > /> »
 > ^ .if f^zZl dW* J-V. Jr*J7 iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is
 easierfor Him.} Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means it is easier for Him." '
 Mujahid said: "Repeating it is easier for Him than originating it, and originating it is easy for Him."*2'
 This was also the view of IkTimah and others.*3 Al-Bukh&ri recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah
 be pleased with him, said that the Prophet jgg said: tvilJi d pj ijJi d p fjl ^ JI*5 Ijt tp- ^Aj ^ y ijC\ Al; p
 jp\ Ami A^S/i ulj jAJj i Aiii lilA iSfj toSUj iJ ^5 AijI «Allah says; "The son of Adam denied Me, and he
 had no right to do so. And he reviled Me, and he had no right to do so. Asfor his denying Me, it is his
 saying: 'He mil not remake me as He originated me' - while originating the creation is not easierforMe
 than re-creating him . As for his reviling Me, it is his saying: 'Allah has taken to Himself a son,' while I
 am the One, the Self-Sufficient Master; I beget not, nor was I begotten, and there is none comparable to
 Me." This was recorded only by Al-Bukhari.**' a0£3 111 At-Tabari 20:92. * AMabari 20:92. * At-
 Tabari 20 :92 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :611 612.

542Surah 30. Ar-Rum (28 - 29) (Part-21) {His is the highest description in the heavens and in the
 earth.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported Ibn 'Abbas said, "This is like the Ayah: iThere is nothing like Him}
 (42:11)." Qatadah said: "His description is La. ilaha tilalldh, and there is no Lord but He." jXLii! 'fjri.jf
 « IS j3l o? ,J3 £^ gi Jf ^28 . He sets forth for you a parable from yourselves : Do you have partners
 among those whom your right hands possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you,
 whom you fear as you fear each other? Thus do We explain the signs in detail to a people who have
 sense.} 429. Nay, but those who do wrong follow their own lusts without knowledge. Then who will
 guide him whom Allah has sent astray? Andfor such there will be no helpers.} A Parable ofTawhtd•
 This is the parable Allah makes of the idolators, those who worship others besides Him and attribute
 partners to Him, while at the same time admitting that these so-called partners - idols and false gods -
 are enslaved to and belong to Him. In their Talbiyah (during Hajj and 'Umrah they used to say, "At
 Your service, You have no partner except the partner that You have, You own Him and whatever he
 owns." If £^} iHe setsforthfor you a parablefrom yourselves} 'something which you yourselves can see
 witness, and understand.' 4Do you have partners among those whom your right hands

542 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you...?} ‘None of you would like to have his servant as a partner in his wealth, each of them having an equal share.’ in whom you fear as you fear each other.} *You fear that they will have a share in your wealth with you.’ Abu Mijlaz said, “You do not fear that your servant will have a share in your wealth, because he has no such right; similarly, Allah has no partner.” ‘The point is, that since any one of you would abhor such a thing, how can you attribute rivals to Allah from among His creation? At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The people of Shirk used to say in their Talbiyah, ‘At Your service, You have no partner except the partner that You have, You own Him and whatever he owns.’ Then Allah revealed the words: Sip *_j J=s£ijj C ^ il£==«r^ J* U iDo you have partners among those whom your right hands possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you, whom you fear as you fear each other?}”™ If humans have this characteristic, this parable shows that it is even less befitting for Allah to have a partner. jjiJ f \$Thus do We explain the signs in detail to a people who have sense.} Then Allah points out that when the idolaters worship others instead of Him, doing so out of their own folly and ignorance: 4Nay, but those who do wrong fallow...}, meaning, the idolaters, 111 At-Jabari 20:96. AJ-Tabarfini 12 :20 , with a weak chain of narration

4...their own lusts} means, in their worship of false gods without knowledge. ^JZ} iThen who will guide him whom Allah has sent astray?} means, no one can guide them if Allah has decreed that they will be misguided. 4And for such there will be no helpers .} means, there is no one who can save them from the power of Allah or grant them a way out, for what He wills, happens and what He does not will, does not happen. *?!. V Aiff Jji S' \j& A iyjs % 4ij^of^t (Vr_J tL 430. So, set you your face towards the religion as a Hanif. Allah's Fitrah with which He has created mankind. No change let there be in Allah's Khalq, that is the straight religion, but most men know not.} 431. (And remain always) turning in repentance to Him and have Taqwa of Him; and perform the Salah and be not of idolaters.} 432. Of those who split up their religion, and became sects, each sect rejoicing in that which is with it.} The Command to adhere to Tawhid• Allah says: ‘so set your face and persevere in the religion which Allah has prescribed for you, the worship of Allah Alone, the religion of Ibrahim, to which Allah has guided you and which He has perfected for you with the utmost perfection. In this manner, you will also adhere to the sound Fitrah with which He created His creation.’ Allah created His

tjiJ JtJ4 4No change let there be in Allah's Khalq,} “It means, the religion of Allah, and the religion, and the Fitrah is Islam.” Then he reported that Abu Hurayrah said, “The Messenger of Allah sg said: j\ j I oljjli S^kiJl l_Jj’ V) JJjj ijJ* Jj* li «No child is born except in a state of Fitrah, then his parents make him a Jew or a Christian or a Zoroastrian, just as each animal produces a perfect animal like itself - do you see any among them that are born mutilated?» then the narrator (Abu Hurayrah) said (recite this Ayah), 4^ ‘il jyj V J,\3\ j& \$\\$ ojJb iAllah’s Fitrah with which He has created mankind. No change let there be in Allah’s Khalq, that is the straight religion.}” This was also recorded by Muslim.111 4^1 !:if 4that is the straight religion, means, adherence to the Shari’ah and the sound Fitrah is the true, straight religion. 4& v 4but most men know not.} means, most people do not know this and they deviate far astray from it, as Allah says: 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) u* Jljt-i« Jfji\ j a* ^ j£} 4And if you obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far away from Allah's path (6:1 16). Id FathAl-Bari 8 :372 11:512, Muslim 4 :2047 , 2048

turning in repentance to Him} Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jurayj said, "This means, returning to Him." and have Taqwa of Him;} means, fear Him and remember that He is always watching. and perform the Salah}, which is the greatest act of worship.^ and be not of the idolaters.} Be of those who single out Allah, devoting their worship sincerely for Him alone, not anyone or anything other than Him. Ibn Jarir recorded that Yazid bin Abi Maryam said: "Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, passed by Mu'adh bin Jabal and asked, What is the foundation of this Ummah? Mu'adh said, Three things, and they are the things that will bring salvation: Al-Ikhlâs (doing a deed for Allah alone), which is the Fitrah with which Allah created mankind; Salah, which is the thing that tells a believer apart from a disbeliever; and obedience, which is protection.' "Umar said: You have spoken the truth. "I21 Splitting into Sects and the Saved Sect131 His saying: f*r.3 y p&i bu* yf iOf those who Farraqn Dtnahum (split up their religion), and became sects, each sect rejoicing in that which is with it.} means, do not be of the idolaters who split up their religion, i.e., changed it by believing in parts of it and rejecting other parts. Some scholars read this as Faragu Dinahum, meaning At-Tabari 20:100 AMabari 20 :98. * This is one of the headings added to the English version of this book.

J i • A J^©f10iiA24PiAi3^i: ' ? * "'\ ' ft*' -> » > • A 'Ss.s *fit1 l^>-^c^^ul "eLiJ^J 10 /j L' j. *~^..l;l LU^ilUiOluij0 iiU'j IJy^tijjJjd c£jJl<Ult^0 t'j«a«waJ'»i8>dLjljb^l>(<ia^i>^'»«^j3 '.'" >-'.' *e ' . V,' ->-"•' iVr/> \$o^..i> 0<j>*5^(>4^ c£J)'y*jj»^jJp-Q I(JICI ^^^^“neglected their religion and left it behind them.” These are like the Jews, Christians, Zoroastrians, idol worshippers and all the followers of false religions, besides the followers of Islam, as Allah says: (Irii 'At* Ctift p*^/LS) {ijr J (i{ij c-ll 4^Ji iVerily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, you have no concern in them in the least. Their affair is only with Allahb (6:159). The followers of the religions before us had differences of opinions and split into false sects, each group claiming to be following the truth. This Ummah too has split into sects, all of which are misguided apart from one, which is Ahlus-Sunnah Wal-Jama'ah, those who adhere to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah^ and what was followed by the first generations, the Companions, their followers, and the Imams of the Muslims of earlier and later times. In his Mustadrak, Al-Hakim recorded that the Messenger of Allah was asked which of the sects was the saved sect and he said: j <lip lit l*B zWhat I and my Companions are upon .s* 1 ' 111 Al-yakim 1:129.

o^J 't? \fzf ***--> cr*-- r-i •*** i 9 *+* [**M «j o) jjip <>J o_£jri 4i»' J it/ pi j*pjJ c-*jS 4 5'^^ 433. And when harm touches men, they cry sincerely only to their Lord, turning to Him in repentance; but when He gives them a taste of His mercy, behold, a party of them associates partners in worship with their Lord.} 434. So as to be ungrateful for the graces which We have bestowed on them. Then enjoy; but you will come to know.} 435. Or have We revealed to them an authority, which speaks of that which they have been associating with Him?} 436. And when We cause mankind to taste of mercy, they rejoice therein; but when some evil afflicts them because of what their limbs have sent forth, behold, they are in despair!} 437. Do they not see that Allah expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (it for whom He wills). Verily, in that are indeed signs for a people who believe.} How man sways between Tawhid and Shirk, and between Joy and Despair, according to His Circumstances Allah tells us that when man is in dire straits, he calls upon Allah alone with no partner or associate, then when times of ease come and they have the choice, some people associate others with Allah and worship others alongside Him. 4So as to be ungrateful for the graces which We have bestowed on

them.} Then Allah warns them by saying: ibut you will come to know.} One ofthem said: By Allah, if a law

enforcment officer were to say this to me, I would be afraid, so how about when the One Who is issuing the warning is the One Who merely says to a thing “Be!” and it is? Then Allah denounces the idolators for fabricating lies and worshipping others instead ofHim with no evidence or proof: ft 40r have We revealed to them an authority,} means, proof. ip iwhich speaks} means, tells iof that which they have been associating with Him?} This is a rhetorical question intended to denounce them, for they have no such thing. iAnd when We cause mankind to taste of mercy, they rejoice therein ; but when some evil afflicts them because ofwhat their hands have sent forth, behold, they are in despair!} This is a denunciation of man for the way he is, except for those whom Allah protects and helps, for when man is given blessings, he is proud, and says: it&Mf* M Xsf v*->? 47/Zs have departed from me.” Surely, he is exultant, and boastful.} (11:10) He rejoices over himself and boasts to others, but when difficulties befall him, He despairs of ever having anything good again. Allah says: 4Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds}. They are patient during times of difficulty and do good deeds at times of ease. It was reported in the Sahih: oU.1 o! 13 \js- b\s Vi ;uJ iJ iii

550 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 8<J 1 iljJ? <CtL^f jlJ l <! I «How wonderful is the affair of the believer. Allah does not decree anything for him but it is good for him. Ifgood things happen to him, he gives thanks, and that is good for him; and if bad things happen to him, he bears that with patience, and that is goodfor him .s 4->-iffi ilS iiEl' Jhu <ji' 3^ \fj iDo they not see that Allah expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (itfor whom He wills).} He is the One Who is controlling and doing that, by His wisdom and justice, so He expands the provision for some people and restricts it for some. iVerily, in that are indeed signsfor a people who believe.} Jbljtj 4jif ' ty fti ju ^ U IjJ o# ty jti J-3 j^JLb is j^aU- ttjJi ii' *2-j 438. So, give to the kindred his due, and to Al-Miskin and to the wayfarer. That is bestfor those who seek Allah's Face; and it is they who will be successful.} 439. And that which you give in Riba in order that it may increase from other people's property, has no increase with Allah; but that which you give in Zakah seeking Allah's Face, then those they shall have manifold increase.} 440. Allah is He Who created you, then providedfoodfor you, then will cause you to die, then He will give you life. Is there any ofyour partners that do anything ofthat? Glory be to Him! And Exalted be He above all that they associate.} Muslim 4 :2295

The Command to uphold the Ties of Kinship and the Prohibition ofRiba Allah commands giving: 4to the kindred his due^ his due of respect and upholding the ties ofkinship. iand to Al-Misktn} the one who has nothing to spend on his needs, or he has something but it is not enough. SS 4and to the wayfarer.} the traveler who is in need of money and other things during his journey. iThat is bestfor those who seek Allah's Face;} meaning; to look upon Him on the Day of Resurrection, which is the ultimate aim. 4^}^} iand it is they who will be successful.} means, in this world and the Hereafter. Then Allah says: jlc [gjt Mi M JyS -j gy iiJ }And that which you give in Riba, in order that it may increase from other people's property, has no increase with Allah;} This means, that which is given as a gift to others in the hope that they will give back more than they were given. There is no reward for this with Allah. This is how this Ayah was interpreted by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah,

Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Ka*b and Ash-Sha'bi. 11 * Allah says: 4but that which you give in Zakdh seeking Allah's Face, then IM AKTabari 20:104, 105.

\ ^ ' i . t . ^ U » • / t ^ • > A Cjll5y>juiojj> Lr'^rjJt^Jo'Jo / ^ ^ ^). * s s * s • //)> * V" Kpo^O_ ^J^ yo • > * S- ^ " ^ * V/ > / ' + ' } * S + Sy • > * « ' . " ^ y » _ j dvpu^SCij 5A^C~AA ' %ajC^oi : » ^ t l A * v l ~ ^ ^ j - 4 ^ o * J - ^ i y ^ o J J \$ 4 dial do anything of that? } meaning, none of them are able to do any of that. But Allah is the One Who is In- dependent in His powers of creation, provision, and giving life and death. Then He will resurrect His creation on the Day of Resurrection. This is why, after all this He says: £2; ^ . } i ^ A A i Glory be to Him! And Exalted be He above all that they associate. } meaning, exalted and sanctified and glorified be He far above having any partner, peer, equal, son or father, for He is the One, the Unique, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who begets not nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable unto Him. i » f U J \ j i f c J j ' } j a u j J _ o j i l i * s f } c * » — W f i i b A q A - i l ' f - A } i f - A & A ' A i i A ^ < j f y - ; J 4 A A A 442 . Evil has appeared in Al-Barr and Al-Bahr because of what the hands of mm have earned, that He may make them taste a part of that which they have done, in order that they may return . } 442. Say: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those before (you)! Most of them were idolaters." }

554 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Effects of Sin in this World Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Sudd! and others said: “What is meant by Al-Barr here is the empty land or wilderness, and by Al-Bahr is towns and cities.” ^ 1 According to a report narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas and ‘Ikrimah, Al-Bahr refers to towns and cities which are on the banks of rivers . Others said that what was meant was the usual meaning of the words, i.e., land and sea. Zayd bin Rafi‘ said: iEvil has appeared> “The rain is withheld from the land and this is followed by famine, and it is withheld from the sea, adversely affecting the animals which live in it.” This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim, who said: “Muhammad bin ‘Abdullah bin Yazld Al- Muqri' told us, from Sufyan from Humayd bin Qays Al-A‘raj from Mujahid: iEvil has appeared on land and sea> “Evil on land means the killing of the son of Adam, and evil on the sea means piracy.” According to the first opinion, the phrase, iEvil has appeared on land and sea because of what the hands of men have earned,> means the shortfall in the crops and fruits is because of sins. Abu Al-‘Aliyah said: “Whoever disobeys Allah in the earth has corrupted it, because the good condition of the earth and the heavens depends on obedience to Allah.” Hence it says in the Hadlth which was recorded by Abu Dawud: J fuj Jill “Any prescribed punishment which is carried out in the land is better for its people than if it were to rain for forty days, a131 At-Jabari 20:108. At-Tabari 20:108. [31 An-Nasal 8:75.

555 Surah 30. Ar-Rum (41 - 42) (Part-21)

The reason for that is that if the prescribed punishments are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4421]

carried out, this will deter the people - most or many of them - from violating the prohibitions of Allah. If they give up sin, this will be a cause of blessings in the skies and on the earth. So, when “Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, comes down at

the end of time, he will judge according to this Shari‘ah at

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4421–4423]

that time, and will kill the pigs and break the cross and abolish the Jizyah. He will accept nothing except Islam or the sword. When Allah destroys the Dajjal and his followers, and Ya'juj and Ma'juj during his time, it will be said to the earth, bring forth your blessing. Then groups of people will eat from one pomegranate, and will seek shade beneath its skin, and the milk of one pregnant camel will be sufficient for a group of people. This will only be because of the blessings that will result from application of the SharVah of Muhammad ag. The more justice is established, the more the blessings and' good things will increase. It was reported in the Sahih: yJiiVj ^ oii >;.u3i !ii» *When the evildoer dies, it is a relieffor the people, the land, the trees and the animals. n11 ' Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded that Abu Qahdham said: "At the time of Ziyad or Ibn Ziyad, a man found a cloth in which were wrapped grains ofwheat which were as big as date stones; on it was written: This grew at a time when justice prevailed."**21 4that He may make them taste a part of that which they have done,) means, He tries them with the loss of wealth, souls and fruits as a test and as a punishment for what they have done. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim mentioned it without a chain of narrators under the explanation of this Ayah. Without the addition of 'Then he recited...' until the end, it was recorded by At-Tirmidhi no. 2013 and others, and it is considered a Hasan Hadith *21 Ahmad 2 :296, with aweak chain ofnarration.

iin order that thexj may return .} means, from disobedience. This is like the Ayah, '^>*5* (H» *s**s^5 4And We tried them with good and evil in order that might turn.) (7:168). Then Allah says: they iSay: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those before (you)!"} meaning, those who came before you. 4'4^J&J iMost of them were idolaters.} means, so see what happened to them when they rejected the Messengers and were ungrateful for the blessings. [>*-& &*>* j& i- -a' > > ' t: t • ' ' 443. So, set you your face to the straight and right religion, before there comes from Allah a Day which none can avert. On that Day men shall be divided .} 444. Wfwsoever disbelieves will suffer from his disbelief, and whosoever does righteous good deeds, then such will prepare a good placefor themselves .} 445. That He may reward those who believe and do righteous good deeds, out of His bounty. Verily, He likes not the disbelievers .} The Command to follow the Straight Path before the Day ofResurrection Here Allah commands His servants to hasten to obedience to Him and to hasten to do good deeds. 4^ li/i A if y uUiJ 4So, set you yourface to the straight and right religion, before

there comesfrom Allah a Day which none can averts

The Day of Resurrection, for when Allah wants it to happen,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4423–4434]

no one will be able to avert it. -U-y} iOti that Day men shall be divided. means, they will be separated, with one group in Paradise and another in Hell. Allah says: 4/jjl i'+i ioJLL* £r*y iWhosoever disbelieves will suffer from his disbelief, and ivhosoever does righteous good deeds, then such will prepare a good place for themselves. That He may reward those who believe, and do righteous good deeds, out ofHis bounty.> meaning that He may reward them from His bounty, in return for one good deed, he will get the reward for ten, up to seven hundred like it, as much as Allah wills. 4i -5 iVerily, He likes not the disbelievers.} yet He is still just with them and does not oppress them. •? / *" |' z- ,> 1 ZZ . y\ !>*% -is'o 0: fW Jfjj j our z Z* ZZ ^ # #Z Z Z^^ Z »z Z»z i zZZ^ Z ^iZfZ Azz Z^ #z lu okxJL -xiJj 4 ^ uib ik /z-ift Ti'j <(46. And among His signs is this that He sends the winds as glad tidings, giving you

a taste of His mercy, and that the ships may sail at His command, and that you may seek of His bounty, in order that you may be thankful.} 447. And indeed We did send Messengers before you to their own peoples. They came to them with clear proofs, then, We took vengeance on those who committed crimes; and it was incumbent upon Us to help the believers.} Among the Signs of Allah are the Winds Here Allah mentions the favor He does for His creatures by sending winds to them, as harbingers of His mercy, meaning

that they will be followed by rain. Allah says: (giving you a taste of His mercy,) that is, the rain which will come down and revive people and the land. (and that the ships may sail at His command,) means, on the sea, for they are driven by the wind. (and that you may seek of His bounty,) means, by trading, earning a living and traveling from one country to another, one region to another. (in order that you may be thankful.) means, that you may give thanks to Allah for the innumerable favors He has done for you, both visible and hidden. Then Allah says: (And indeed We did send Messengers before you to their own peoples. They came to them with clear proofs, then, We took vengeance on those who committed crimes;) These are words of consolation from Allah to His servant and Messenger Muhammad (ﷺ). They tell him that if many of his people and of mankind disbelieve in him, the previous Messengers were also rejected, despite the clear signs that they brought, but Allah punished those who rejected and opposed them, and saved those who believed in them. (and it was incumbent upon Us to help the believers.) This is a duty which Allah took upon Himself as a blessing and a favor to them. This is like the Ayah, (your Lord has prescribed mercy for Himself) (6:54). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ad-Darda', may Allah be

pleased with him, (—r ; \X"v . > -> 'J ;// ^ <<• - > > ^rf. .W/Jf'Y 'Z*' .<{ \ \ " .>I*V\ - i.T> *^s?' *-t> */ i i x ps£. ^ * •+** */ < i> // _ >> "J L>J^*J^>* Jifc(joz&l said: "I heard Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) saying: J* >s. (4^ JcS4' ot U>- jl5 Ml <>•! j fji (--<' J^> *£ ^ji jil •iiQjl »No Muslim man defends the honor of his brother except that there would be a right upon Allah to defend him from the fire of Hell on the Day of Resurrection. Then he recited this Ayah: ^ <£ & 4&P (and it was incumbent upon Us to help the believers.) ^ <Xa» XxJ>) fcj JS ^lilf j lijji iff 4 IjJ iwCe <Si «S» (>* ** li£ .^tL- # £>4 jjji' ^ c^j ^i: ai >U .45 o*:># s: J£ ot ^ i£J# *£ ^ # _£ <pi *3 Si £Vf -eJ-*> S; !a^ i^*4i »j1> 448. Allah is He Who sends the winds, so that they raise clouds and spread them along the sky as He wills, and then break them into fragments until you see rain drops come forth from their midst! Then when He has made them fall on whom of His servants as He wills, lo, they rejoice!} *** Similar was recorded by Al-Bukhfi, no. 6512

449. And verily, before that - just before it was sent down upon them - they were in despair!} 450. Look then at the effects of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death. Verily, that shall indeed raise the dead, and He is able to do all things.} 451 . And if We send a wind, and they see it (turn) yellow - behold, they then would become unthankful (disbelievers) .} The Revival of the Earth is a Sign of the Resurrection Here Allah explains how He creates the clouds that rain the water. 4Allah is He Who sends the winds, so that they raise clouds either from the sea, as was mentioned by more than one (of the scholars), or from whatever Allah wills. 4* & i j (Dalxj} 4and spread them along the sky as He wills,} means, He spreads them and causes them to increase and grow. From a little He makes a lot, and creates the clouds that look like shields. Then He spreads them out until they fill the horizon.

Sometimes the clouds come from the sea, heavy and full, as Allah says: *VliS Ijl 4* And it is He *Wlw* sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy. Till when they have carried a heavy-laden cloud, We drive it to a land that is dead until: *il* jp'f jg. 4* Similarly, We shall raise up the dead, so that you may remember or take heed.} (7:57) Allah says here: *^ J 4* Allah is He *Wlw* sends the winds, so that they raise clouds

567 Siirah 30. Ar-Riim (48 - 57) (Part-21) and spread them along the sky as He wills, and then break them into fragments[^] Mujahid, Abu 'Amr bin Al-'Ala', Matar Al-Warraq and Qatadah said, "This means pieces." Others said that it means 'piled up,' as Ad-Dahhak said. Others said that it means black, because they contained so much water, and sometimes they are heavy and close to the earth. His saying: *4..4^r it iuntil you see rain drops come forth from their midst!*} means, 'so you see the drops, i.e., the rain, which come from the midst of those clouds.' *'ij isjL^ ibi ,y .Ai i* Then when He has made them fall on whom of His servants as He wills, lo, they rejoice!} They rejoice at the rain when it comes to them because of their need for it. *Jt o* crt jj)? i* And verily, before that - just before it was sent down upon them - they were in despair!} The people to whom this rain came were in despair, thinking that it rain would never fall, just before it came to them. When it came to them, it came at the time of greatest need, so it was a tremendous event for them What this means is that they were in need of it before it fell, and there had been no rainfall for a long time, so they were waiting for it at the time when it was due, but it did not come to them at that time. The rain was late, and a long time passed. Then the rain came to them suddenly, after they began to despair, and after their land became dry and barren, it was stirred to life, and it swelled and produced every lovely kind of growth. Allah says: *^ til -i^ 4* Look then at the effects of Allah's mercy,} meaning, the rain, *m At-Jabari 20:114.*

563 Surah 30. Ar-Rum (52 - 53) (Part-21) can make to hear only those who believe in Our Ayat, and have submitted (to Allah in Islam).) The Disbelievers are like the Dead, Deaf and Blind Allah says, 'just as you are not able to make the dead hear in their graves, or to make your words reach the deaf who cannot hear and who still turn away from you, so too you cannot guide the blind to the truth and bring them back from their misguidance.' That is a matter which rests with Allah, for by His power He can make the dead hear the voices of the living if He wills. He guides whom He wills and sends astray whom He wills, and no one but He has the power to do this. Allah says: *(*4* 44% v i* you can make to hear only those who believe in Our Ayat, and have submitted (to Allah in Islam).) means, those who are humble and who respond and obey. These are the ones who will listen to the truth and follow it; this is the state of the believers; the former (being deaf and blind) is the state of the disbelievers, as Allah says: *Jr ii' t|?« ^ J'j 1 I* It is only those who listen will respond, but as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.) (6:36) 'A'ishah, the Mother of the faithful, may Allah be pleased with her, used this Ayah - 44P' *? •At i So verily, you cannot make the dead to hear) as evidence against 'Abdullah bin 'Umar when he reported that the Prophet *sg* had addressed the slain disbelievers who had been thrown into a dry well three days after the battle of Badr, rebuking and reprimanding them, until 'Umar said, "O Messenger of Allah, are you addressing people who are dead bodies?" He said: *V jfoU jUif U ;J1 ^JJly* «By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, you do not hear what

565 Surah 30. Ar-Rum (54 - 57) (Part-21 whatever way He wants. *4^ %}* 4 And He is the All-Knowing, the All-Powerful.} •xV / V /»' «x» < r / < X/ * > * ^ J, . *x/ x* »x i > { / ix pi ^-A2_43 cJLJI 4\$ (j -XjJ

plaf £ju)t ^ i'^ ^ g v ^3 v 4r°KS ^55. And on f/je Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour - thus were they ever deluded.} 456. And those who have been bestowed with knowledge and Faith will say: "Indeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until the Day of Resurrection; so this is the Day of Resurrection, but you knew not."} 457. So, on that Day no excuse of theirs will avail those who did wrong, nor will they be allowed to return to seek (Allah's) pleasure.} The Ignorance of the Disbelievers in this World and in the Hereafter Here Allah tells us of the ignorance of the disbelievers in this world and in the Hereafter. In this world they worship idols, and in the Hereafter they will also display great ignorance. They will swear by Allah that they did not even stay for one hour in this world. They will mean that there was not enough time given to establish proof against them which would leave them with no excuse. Allah says: >j: dj <3 >-tJ jjJ (*yi ! A>' J'b \j£ <£&)&'} 4thus were they ever deluded. And those who have been bestowed with knowledge and Faith will say: "Indeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until the Day of Resurrection .. ."} The believers who have knowledge of the Hereafter will

respond to them, just as they established the proof of Allah against them in this world. When they swear that they did not stay even one hour in this world, they will say to them: ^Indeed you have stayed according to the decree ofAllah,} meaning, the Book of deeds, £& iutil the Day of Resurrection ;} means, "from the day when you were created until the dayyou were resurrected.' ibut you knew not.} Allah says: ^So, on that Day} meaning, the Day of Resurrection, ino excuse of theirs will avail those wlv did wrong,} means, their excuses for what they did. inor will they be allowed (then) to return to seek (Allah's) pleasure.} means, they will not be allowed to return to this world. This is like the Ayah, Sj (**& iand if they seek to please (Allah), yet they are not ofthose who will ever be allowed to please (Allah)} (41:24). (| v vjg \$> ki tiiSM i '\$ k i58. And indeed We have setforthfor mankind, in this Qur'an every kind of parable. But if you bring to them any sign or proof, the disbelievers are sure to say (to the believers): "You

567Surah 30. Ar-Riim (58 - 60) (Part-21 follow nothing butfalsehood and magic."} 459. Thus does Allah seal up the hearts of those who know not.} 460. So be patient. Verily, the promise ofAllah is true; and let not those who have no certainty offaith discourage you (from conveying Allah's Message).} Parables in the Qur'an and bow the Disbelievers do not learn from them 4S^f ot 'jcj* x&j} 4And indeed We have set forth for mankind, in this Qur'an every kind ofparable.} means. We have explained the truth to them and have made it clear to them, and have set forth for them parables so that they may understand the truth and follow it.' ol c/j)\ i-kj jjSj} 4But ifyou bring to them any sign or proof, the disbelievers are sure to say (to the believers): "You follow nothing butfalsehood and magic."} If they were to see any kind of sign, whether it was at their own direction or otherwise, they would not believe in it and they would think that it was magic and falsehood, as they said when the moon was cleft asunder, etc., as Allah says: 4Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97). Allah says here: V »-yli ii' 4Thus does Allah seal up the hearts of those who know not. So be patient. Verily, the promise ofAllSh is true;} meaning, bear their stubborn opposition with patience, for Allah will fulfill His promise to grant you victory over them

56S Tafsir Ibn Kathir and cause you and those who follow you to prevail in this world and in the Hereafter.’ let not those who have no certainty offaith discourage you (from conveying Allah’s Message). ‘Remain steadfast in the mission with which Allah has sent you, for it is truth in which there is no doubt. Do not turn away from it, for nowhere else is there truth which is to be followed; the truth rests exclusively in the Message with which you have been sent.’ ReportsconcerningtheVirtuesofthisSurahand that it is recommended to recite it during Fajr Imam Ahmad recorded from a man among the Companions of the Prophet sfe that the Messenger of Allah jfa, led them in Fajr prayer and recited Ar-Rum in the prayer, but he became confused in his recitation. He said: jy... X jjLai Uljif jli blip <"! t Jl y—>»-b CLa .XpJ. “We have become confused in our recitation of Qur’an, because some people among you are praying with us but they have not performed Wudii’ properly. Whoever attends the prayer with us, let him perform Wudu’ properly.^ This has a Hasan chain of narration, the text itself is Hasan. It contains amazing information, that the Prophet was affected by the faulty Wudu’ of some of those whom he was leading in prayer. This indicates that the prayer of the person who is praying in the congregation is connected to the prayer of the Imam.

Surah 31: Luqman

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4435]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Luqman (Chapter - 31)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4435–4449]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. t\ (\»4pJ AjO 1 e^V^cy^J r > . lC < *> S ,/' '*>' / . jVK^ -Jyy. S'S okjliUiU oj^j^p j£- jjo -^3oo o& />/^ > 'x? ' \ty <3*->*Vsp oWljfcj^ t>Ifii/ ' > // , / . ^^ ^ / ' *•*> i» i& ii; ^ i: ^if c/jJ^ . ^ . lift— ' *?» ".5^.# *)•>/ / < / > 0-t tW-> i a .o>>4i*I' |*-> liUJlj (*«j> il. AlifLam Mim .} 42. These are Aydt of the Wise Book 43 . A guide and a mercy for the Muhsinin .} 44. Those ivho perform the Saldh and give Za- kah and they have faith in the Hereafter with certainty 45 . Such are on guidance from their Lord, and such are the successful.} At the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah we discussed the letters such as those that appear at the beginning of this Surah. Allah has made the Qur'an a guidance and healing and a mercy for the Muhsinin, who are those who do good deeds in accordance with the

572Surah 31 . Luqman (6 - 7) (Part-21 fear their Lord shiverfrom it. Then their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance ofAllah} (39:23). He connect that with mention of the doomed, those who turn away from the Qur'an and do not benefit from hearing the Words of Allah. Instead, they turn to listening to flutes and singing accompanied by musical instruments. As Ibn Mas*ad commented about the Ayah: Siff" if- J-jJ iSfLJ 4And of mankind is he who purchases Lahii Al-Hadith to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah}, he said, “This - by Allah - refers to singing.” 4f? if J-jJ if ifj} iAnd of mankind is he who purchases Lahw Al-Hadith to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah without knowledge,} Qatadah said: “By Allah, he may not spend money on it, but his purchasing it means he likes it, and the more misguided he is, the more he likes it and the more he prefers falsehood to the truth and harmful things over beneficial things.”*2 It was said that what is meant by the words Si 4purchases idle talks} is buying singing servant girls. Ibn Jarir said that it means all speech that hinders people from seeing the signs ofAllah and following His path.*3 His saying: 4\$ o* s 4to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah} means, he does this to oppose Islam and its followers. iand takes it by way of mockery.} Mujahid said, “This means At-Tabari 20 :127 * At-Tabari 20:127. * At-Tabari 20:130.

mocking the path ofAllah and making fun of it.”111 iPP p }For such there will be a humiliating torment.} Just as they showed no respect to the signs and path of Allah, so they will be shown no respect on the Day of Resurrection, and they will be subjected to a painful, ongoing torment. Then

Allah says: iAnd when Our Ayat are recited to such a one, he turns away in pride, as if he heard than not - as if there were deafness in his ear.} means, when these Qur'anic verses are recited to one who is fond of idleness and play, he turns away from them and does not want to hear them. He turns a deaf ear to them as if he can hear nothing, because it annoys him to hear them since he gains no benefit from them and has no interest in them. ifJ} iSo announce to him a painful torment.} i.e., on the Day of Resurrection, which will hurt him just as much as listening to the Book ofAllah and its verses hurt him. />/ .»/ * // »» / £ p i ip: u} jP }8. Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them are Gardens of Delight.} 49. To abide therein. It is a promise ofAllah in truth. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} The Good Destiny ofthe Believers Here Allah mentions the destiny of the righteous in the Hereafter, those who believe in Allah and His Messenger m and do righteous deeds in accordance with the Laws of Allah. p¥ m At-Tabari 20:131.

573Surah 31. Luqmdn (10 - 37) (Part-21) 4for them are Gardens of Delight.} means, there they will enjoy all kinds of delights and pleasures, food, drink, clothing, dwelling- places, means of transportation, women, a light of beauty and delightful sounds, which have never crossed the mind of any human being. They will stay there forever, never leaving and never desiring change. <i' ^c.j} ilt is a promise ofAllah in truth.} meaning, this will undoubtedly come to pass, for it is a promise from Allah, and Allah never breaks His promise, because He is the Most Generous Bestower Who does what He wills and is able to do all things. }And He is the All-Mighty,> Who has subjugated all things and to Whom all things submit, ithe All-Wise.} in what He says and what He does, Who has made this Qur'an a guidance to the believers. 4Say : "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it is blindnessfor them (41:44). 4 .-A'U L>L—*• " ^1 oybbt ieo oj 4And We send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe, and it increases the wrongdoers nothing but loss.} (17:82) ot q, *s* l» -v-? ^ (s^isj ufoVi' j ff. 3&} tY. »</ • **. / " - A. 430. He has created the heavens without any pillars that you see, and has set on the earth firm mountains lest it should shake with you. And He has scattered therein moving creatures of all

kinds. And We send down water from the sky, and We cause (plants) ofevery goodly kind to grow therein in pairs,} i'll. This is the creation of Allah. So, shew Me that which those besides Him have created. Nay, the wrongdoers are in plain error.} Proofs of Tawhid Thus Allah explains His mighty power in creating the heavens and the earth, and everything that is within them and between them. He says: }He has created the heavens without any pillars} Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, "It does not have any pillars, visible or invisible." iand has set on the earthfirm mountains} means, the mountains which stabilize and lend weight to the earth, lest it should shake with its water. Allah says: ilest it should shake with you.} 4 vt £*>} }And He has scattered therein moving creatures ofall kinds} means, He has placed throughout it all kinds of animals, the total number of whose kinds and colors is known to no one except the One Who created them. When Allah tells us that He is the Creator, He also reminds us that He is the Provider, as He says: 4*-^' Jt U_>1 iAnd We send down water from the sky, and We cause (plants) ofevery goodly kind to grow therein in pairs,} meaning, every kind of good produce in pairs, i.e., they are At-Tabari 20 :132

575Siirah 31. Luqmdn (12) (Part-21) beautiful to look at. Ash-Sha'bi said: "People are also produce of the earth, so whoever enters Paradise is goodly and whoever enters Hell is vile." 477ns is the creation of Allah.} means, all that Allah has mentioned here of the creation of the heavens and earth and everything in be- tween stems from His power of creation and control alone, and He has no partner or as- sociate in that, Allah says: Ot V& Cjk- *~uX*} Him have created.} those idols and rivals whom you worship and call upon. 4Nay, the wrongdoers} means the idolators who associate others in worship with Allah <j}/ 4in error} means, they are ignorant and blind. i \r ^ , // >, > / . > A- I y ' *AiOj JoyIt4 > / /V *>V isftj6^iLL4U jyljJkxJ'gft l 4So, s/iow Me Z/iaf zy/iic/i those besides i&} iplain} means, it is clear and obvious, and not at all hidden. 5 " "V // i« a/ /{ / •> { »V ••* *• ^V»j

ill. And indeed We bestowed upon Luqman At-Hibnah saying: "Give thanks to Allah." And whoever gives thanks, he gives thanks for (the good of) himself. And whoever is unthankful, then verily, Allah is All-Rich, Worthy of all praise. Luqman The Salaf differed over the identity of Luqman; there are two opinions: was he a Prophet or just a righteous servant of Allah without the prophethood? The majority favored the latter view, that he was a righteous servant of Allah without being a Prophet. Sufyan Ath-Thawri said, narrating from Al-Ash'ath, from Ikrimah, from Ibn 'Abbas, "Luqman was an Ethiopian slave who was a carpenter." 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said, "I said to Jabir bin 'Abdullah: What did you hear about Luqman?' He said: 'He was short with a flat nose, and came from Nubia.'"² ' Yahya bin Sa'Id Al-Ansari narrated from Sa'Id bin Al- Musayyib that "Luqman was from the black peoples of (southern) Egypt, and had thick lips. Allah gave him wisdom but withheld prophethood from him."³ Al-'Awza'i said, "Abdur-Rahman bin Harmalah told me; 'A black man came to Said bin Al-Musayyib to ask him a question, and Said bin Al-Musayyib said to him: "Do not be upset because you are black, for among the best of people were three who were black: Bilal, Mahja* the freed slave of 'Umar bin Al-Khattab, and Luqman the Wise, who was a black Nubian with thick lips.'"⁴ ' Ibn Jarir recorded that Khalid Ar-Rabal said: "Luqman was an Ethiopian slave who was a carpenter. His master said to him, 'Slaughter this sheep for us,' so he slaughtered it. [His master] said: 'Bring the best two pieces from it,' so he brought out the tongue and the heart. Then time passed, as much as Allah willed, and [his master] said: 'Slaughter this sheep for us,' so he slaughtered it. [His master] said, 'Bring the worst 111 At-Tabari 10:135. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 9 :3097 and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :310. '3| At-Tabari 20:135. '4 ' At-Tabari 20:135.

577Surah 31 . Luqman (13 - 15) (Part-21) two morsels from it,' so he brought out the tongue and the heart. His master said to him, T told you to bring out the best two pieces, and you brought these, then I told you to bring out the worst two pieces, and you brought these!' Luqman said, There is nothing better than these if they are good, and there is nothing worse than these if they are bad.'" Shuhah narrated from Al-Hakam, from Mujahid, "Luqman was a righteous servant, but he was not a Prophet." 12' Allah's saying: 4And indeed We bestowed upon Luqman Al-Hikmahy means, understanding, knowledge and eloquence. i*P'# isaying: "Give thanks to Allah."y means, *We commanded him to give thanks to Allah for the blessings and favors that Allah had given to him alone among his people and contemporaries.' Then Allah says: iP4 <4% i j-yj 4And whoever gives thanks, he gives thanks for (the good of) himself. meaning, the benefit of that will come back to him, and Allah's reward is for those who give thanks, as He says: iand whosoever does righteous good deeds, then such ivill prepare a good placefor themselves. (30:44) 4And whoever is unthankful, then verily, Allah is Rich, Worthy of all

praise. He has no need of His servants and He will not be harmed by that, even if all the people of the earth were to disbelieve, for He has no need of anything or anyone besides Himself. There At-Tabari 20:135. At-Tabari 20:134.

578 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir is no God but He, and we worship none but Him. -iiis -SJ4* <£« %u 1 Zk&% .<& £2 Jii 4 J uylc ii js £ij ^ *12jj bwjj llfik ia pc dll ^ ^15 J Clj_A-£jl iU^ li *^=*^ 3j. -*1 ai J3 Lr“ 4 4c§^ 423. And when Luqman said to his son when he was advising him: "O my son! Join not in worship others with Allah. Verily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed."} 424. And We have enjoined on man (to be dutiful and good) to his parents. His mother bore him in weaktness and hardship upon weabiess and hardship, and his weaning is in two years - give thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} 415. But if they strive ivith you to make you join in worship with Me others that ofwhich you have no knowledge, then obey them not; but behave with them in the world kindly, andfolloiv the path of him who turns to Me in repentance and in obedience. Then to Me will be your rehim, and I shall tell you what you used to do.} Luqman's Advice to His Son Allah tells us how Luqman advised his son. His full name was Luqman bin 'Anqa' bin Sadun, and his son's name was Tharan, according to a saying quoted by As-Suhayli. Allah describes him in the best terms, and states that he granted him wisdom. Luqman advised his son, the closest and most beloved of all people to him, who deserved to be given the best of his knowledge. So, Luqman started by advising him to worship Allah Alone, and not to associate anything with Him. Then he warned him: 4X& !&s iVerily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed.}

579Surah 31 . Luqman (13 - 15) (Part-21) meaning, it is the greatest wrong. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah said: "When the Ayah iJL iIt is those who believe and confuse not their belief with Zulm} [6:B2) was revealed, the Companions of the Messenger of Allah sfe were distressed by this, and said, Who among us does not confuse his belief with Zulm?' The Messenger of Allah said: JJti Ajh\ Afi.i 'i : jUil Jy> ^ V1 till-L i_r~J uThat is not what it means. Have you not heard what Luqman said: iO my son! Join not in worship others with Allah. Verily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed}?*" It was recorded by Muslim.111 When Luqman advised his son to worship Allah Alone, he also told him to honor his parents. This is like the Ayah, •i iAnd your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him. And tliat you be dutiful to your parents (17:23). These two things are often mentioned together in the Qur'an. Allah says here: Vj& ii-Ay Luojoyf }And We have enjoined on man (to be dutiful and good) to his parents. His mother bore him in weakness and hardship upon iveakness and hardship,} Mujahid said: "The hardship of bearing the child."121 Qatadah said: "Exhaustion upon exhaustion."131 'Ata' Al-Khurasani said: "Weakness upon weakness." ioyC q j} 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 372 121 At-Tabari 20:137. 131 At-Tabari 10:137.

580 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iand his weaning is in two years means, after he is bom, he is breastfed and weaned within two years. This is like the Ayah, iiz^ff jtjl Ifo gjjZ, £, i'j&S'j^ iThe mothers shall give suck to their children for two wlvle years, for those who desire to complete the term of suckling} {2:233). On this basis, Ibn 'Abbas and other Imams understood that the shortest possible period of pregnancy was six months, because Allah says elsewhere: ifeZ& iand the bearing of him, and the weaning of him is thirty months (46:15). Allah mentions how the mother brings the child up, and how she gets tired and suffers stress from staying up with the child night and day, to remind the son of her

previous kind treatment of him. This is like the Ayah, and say : “My Lord! Bestow on them Your mercy as they did bring me up when I was young.”} (17:24). Allah says here: ij^aS\ JI J j£=C.\ J} igive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} means, I will reward you most generously for that.’)?’ & (*% ‘it ^ off} iBut if they strive with you to make you join in worship with Me others that of which you have no knowledge, then obey them not;} means, if they try hard to make you follow them in their religion, then do not accept that from them, but do not let that stop you from behaving with them in the world kindly, i.e. treating them with respect. iJ[o* }

581 Surah 31. Luqman (16 - 19) (Part-21) and follow the path of him who turns to Me in repentance and in obedience.} means, the believers. iThen to Me will be your return, and I shall tell you what you used to do.} At-Tabarani recorded in Al-‘Ishrah that Sa’d bin Malik said, “This Ayah, t£)ip ^ At* J if .d’JLjjr Jlj} iBut if they strive with you to make you join in worship with Me others that of which you have no knowledge, then obey them not;} was revealed concerning me. I was a man who honored his mother, but when I became Muslim, she said: ‘O Sa’d! What is this new thing I see you doing? Leave this religion of yours, or I will not eat or drink until I die, and people will say: Shame on you, for what you have done to me, and they will say that you have killed your mother.’ I said, ‘Do not do that, O mother, for I will not give up this religion of mine for anything.’ She stayed without eating for one day and one night, and she became exhausted; then she stayed for another day and night without eating, and she became utterly exhausted. When I saw that, I said: ‘O my mother, by Allah, even if you had one hundred souls and they were to depart one by one, I would not give up this religion of mine for anything, so if you want to, eat, and if you want to, do not eat.’ So she ate.” 1 ’ crpVl j _}i ^ <4 cA f-e~ lit pi ^ % yfcstf J 33 # k& £ ij yi Vj uFA 'i) iK '-Zft-3 4 L Jc _<u>b 4 if !?••* *4 iX" "if in' 4 '•y Op OpV'P ll ' Mentioned by Ibn Al-Athir in Usd Al-Ghdbah 2 :216.

116. "O my son! If it be (anything) equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or on the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well-Aware."} 117. "O my son! Perform the Salah, enjoin the good, and forbid the evil, and bear with patience whatever befalls you. Verily, these are some of the important commandments."} \$18. "And him not your face away from men with pride, nor walk in insolence through the earth. Verily, Allah likes not any arrogant boaster."} 419. "And be moderate in your walking, and lower your voice. Verily, the harshest of all voices is the braying of the asses."} This is useful advice which Allah tells us Luqman gave, so that people may follow it and take it as a good example. He said: ir- Ot JLii* lit o), V' 40 my son! If it be (anything) equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed,} means, if a wrong action or a sin be equal to the size of a grain of mustard seed. 4*j>\ 1 ^ cfc} 4Allah will bring it forth.} means, He will bring it forth on the Day of Resurrection, when it is placed in the Scales of justice and everyone is rewarded or punished for his actions - if they are good, he will be rewarded and if they are bad he will be punished. This is like the Ayat 4^y~“ J-i* Vi -Llj)' y 4And We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything} (21:47).)j* X—u jZj i jji SXu 4So, whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.} (99:7-8)

583 Surah 31. Luqman (16 - 19) (Part-21) Even if this tiny thing were to be hidden inside a solid rock or anywhere in the heavens and the earth, Allah will bring it forth, because nothing is hidden from Him,

not even the weight of a speck of dust in the heavens or on the earth. Allah says: 4 Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well-Aware.} meaning, His knowledge is subtle, for nothing is hidden from Him, no matter how small, subtle and minute. 4 Well-Aware.} even of the footsteps of an ant in the darkest night. Then he (Luqman) said: <5i<J 40 my son! Perform the Salah ,} meaning, offer the prayer properly at the appointed times. 4pi' 25 vbP'k ienjoin the good, and forbid the evil,} meaning, to the best of your ability and strength. iand bear with patience whatever befalls you.} Luqman knew that whoever enjoins what is good and forbids

what is evil, will inevitably encounter harm and annoyance

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4449–4469]

from people, so he told him to be patient. 4jP 6iP k) iVerily, these are some of the important commandments.} means, being patient when people cause harm or annoyance is one of the most important commandments. 4And turn not your face away from men with pride means, 'do not turn your face away from people when you speak to them or they speak to you, looking down on them in an arrogant fashion. Rather be gentle towards them and greet them with a cheerful face,' as it says in the Hadith:

J^r-b •^'ib ?^JJ >^rjj iiU-f l_filj j! »Jii v iuJij «... ey«! (/ it is only by greeting your brother with a cheerful countenance. And beware of letting your lower garment trail below your ankles, for this is a kind of boasting, and Allah does not like boasting »• 1 inor walk in insolence through the earth.} means, 'do not be boastful, arrogant, proud and stubborn. Do not do that, for Allah will hate you.' So he said: t/_>» V Si> j[] 4 Verily, Allah likes not any arrogant boaster.} meaning, one who shows off and admires himself, feeling that he is better than others. And Allah says: ^ JQj v_Jj J Jfo j^ walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height.} (17:37). We have already discussed this in detail in the appropriate place. 121 The Command to be Moderate in Walking 4And be moderate in your walking,} means, walk in a moderate manner, neither slow and lazy nor excessively fast, but be moderate, somewhere in between these two extremes. }and loiver your voice.} means, do not exaggerate in your speaking and do not raise your voice unnecessarily. Allah says: Abu D&wud 4:345. 121 See volume five , the Tafsir of Surat Al-Isra' (17 :37)

^ cjd iVerily, the harshest of all voices is the braying of the asses.} Mujahid and others said, "The most ugly of voices is the voice of the donkey, i.e., when a person raises his voice, the resulting noise is like the voice of a donkey in its loudness. Moreover this is hateful to Allah. Likening a loud voice to that of a donkey implies that it is forbidden and extremely blameworthy, because the Messenger of Allah jg said: *• • 'iz* ij? f w «/f is not befitting ns to be an evil parable. The person who takes back his gift, he is like a dog that vomits and then goes back to his vomit. n* 1 ' The Advice of Luqman This is very useful advice, which the Qur'an tells us about Luqman. Many other proverbs and words of advice were also narrated from him, some examples of which we will quote below, as basic principles: Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Umar said, "The Messenger of Allah sg said: li! 3)1 : Jyu jl£ OUjJ Jl» »Luqman the Wise used to say: when something is entrusted to the care of Allah, He protects It was narrated that As-Sari bin Yahya said: "Luqman said to his son: "Wisdom puts the poor in the company

of kings.”*31 It was also narrated that ‘Awn bin ‘Abdullah said: “Luqman said to his son: ‘O my son! When you come to a gathering of people, greet them with Salam, then sit at the edge of the group, and do not speak until you see that they have finished speaking. Then if they remember Allah, join them, but if they speak of anything else, then leave them and go to another group’.”*41 *** TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi4 :522 Ahmad 2:87. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5:316. * Az-Zuhd by Ibn Al-Mubarak 332

U «i' o' \i/ \$} jr“l> 0f!jV' ly v>*— j£>. ^ .JjOf Vj ^ \$; > t* iyr 'jjj @y^ £& c^ j; t# &\$ JiLLiJt 6l£=>» jljl li*Cl» 4llc 4d^ 4l £ 420. See you not that Allah has subjected for you whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth, and has completed and perfected His graces upon you, apparent and hidden? Yet of mankind is he who disputes about Allah without knowledge or guidance or a Book giving light!} ill . And when it is said to them "Follow that which Allah has sent down," they say: "Nay, we shall follow that which we found our fathers (following)." Even if Shaytan invites them to the torment of the Fire?} Reminder of Blessings Here Allah reminds His creation of the blessings He bestows upon them in this world and the Hereafter. In the heavens He has subjugated for them the stars which give them light during the night and during the day, and He has created clouds, rain, snow and hail, and made the heavens a canopy which covers and protects them. On earth He has created for them stability and rivers, trees, crops and fruits; He has

587 Surah 31. Luqman (22 - 24) (Part-21) completed and perfected His graces upon them, apparent and hidden, by sending Messengers, revealing Books and removing doubts and excuses. Yet despite all this, not all the people believe, and indeed there are those who dispute concerning Allah, that is, His Tawhid, and His sending the Messengers. Their dispute is without knowledge and they have no sound evidence or valid inherited Book. Allah says: <yiS£" Sij <£U 'Jj jf jyu jit 4 JW: <> 4 And among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).} (22:8) meaning clear and unambiguous. 4,\$ Jj } And what it is said to them} means, to these people who dispute about the Oneness of Allah. jyl 'C \jj,\} i" Folloio that which Allah has sent down,"} means, the pure Divine Laws that He has sent down to His Messengers, fSt. iTjLj C^ j; [j!l5^ ithey say: "Nay, we shall follow that which we found our fathers (following)." means, they have no other proof except the fact that they are following their forefathers. Allah says: iEven though their fathers did not understand anything nor were they guided?} (2:170) meaning, Swhat do you think, you who take the forefathers' deeds as proof, that they were misguided and you are following in their footsteps?' Allah says: «_>Uc <j) b£=* j'\$} iEven if Shaydn invites them to the torment of the Fire?}

589 Surah 31. Luqmdn (25 - 28) (Part-21) iWe let them enjoy for a little while,} means, in this world, it then in the end We shall oblige them} means, *We shall cause them,' 4to (enter) a great torment.} means, a torment that is terrifying and difficult to bear. This is like the Ayah, c 2 i" Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful." Enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} (10 : 69-70) v |3SiJ s * as \$ is a# \$. a fic mptp** si ± ck@bsa 125. And if you ask them: "Who has created the heavens and the earth," they will certainly say: "Allah." Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah!" But most of them know not.} 126. To Allah belongs whatsoever is in the heavens and the earth. Verily, Allah, He is Al-Ghani, Worthy of all praise.} The Idolators admitted that Allah is the Creator Allah tells

us that these idolators who associated others with Him admitted that Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, is the Creator of heaven and earth yet they still worshipped others besides Him who they recognized were created by Him and subjugated to Him. Allah says: 4k S3! i ft && uj} i And if you ask them: "Who has created the heavens and the earth," they will certainly say: "Allah." Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah!"} By their admitting that, proof is established against them.

iBut most of them know not Then Allah says: iTo Allah belongs whatsoever is in the heavens and the earth.} meaning, He created it and has dominion over it. 41a< tfx } Verily, Allah, He is Al-Gham, Worthy of all praise.} means, He has no need of anyone or anything besides Himself, and everything else is in need of Him. He is Worthy of praise for all that He has created, so praise be to Him in the heavens and on earth for all that He has created and decreed, and He is worthy of praise in all affairs. OAi Li ji* £. y All' — oj /-Uj Cjt jl} i pz. % piZ t :f u? af k ^ 427. And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea, with seven seas behind it to add to it, yet the Words of Allah would not be exhausted. Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All- Wise.} 428. The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as a single person. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Words ofAllah cannot be counted or exhausted Allah tells us of His might, pride, majesty, beautiful Names and sublime attributes, and His perfect Words which no one can encompass. No human being knows their essence or nature, or how many they are. As the Leader of Mankind and Seal of the Messengers jg said: JU ui oil ini stl: »/ cannot praise You enough; You are as You have praised yourself Allah says: m Muslim 1 :352

591Surah 31 . Luqmdn (29 - 30) (Part-21) U ,iAa) ^ /-L*j >****' ^ Ot (3 P> 4And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea, with seven seas behind it to add to its, yet the Words ofAllah would not be exhausted . meaning, even if all the trees on earth were made into pens and the sea was made into ink, and topped up with seven more like it, and they were used to write the Words of Allah showing His might, attributes and majesty, the pens would break and the ink would run dry, even if more were brought. The number seven is used to indicate a large amount, it is not to be taken literally or to be understood as referring to the seven oceans of the world, as was suggested by those who took this idea from Israelite stories, which we neither believe nor reject. As Allah says elsewhere: \L uv £ JJ JSs J 65, %it jl js» 4Say : "If the sea were ink for the Words ofmy Lord, surely, the sea would be exhausted before the Words ofmy Lord zvould befinished, even ifWe brought like itfor its aid."} (18:109). The words 4like it\$ do not mean merely another one, but another like it and another and another and another, etc., because there is no limit to the signs and Words of Allah. &\$k> 4Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.> means, He is All-Mighty and has subjugated all things to His will, so nothing can prevent what He wills, and none can oppose or put back His decision. He is All-Wise in His creation, commands, Words, actions, Laws and all His affairs. 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only

r^ JjX&im i't \$AJj363d5fc33^0Jiy^ a. Tahir ton Kgtlur &og£? \$^ S' * u' * ."> £ 4 **V^ ^ ^ 4W -X.PJ <: 0_AjI ft^yg;j|i>»ftA J>^S^4 J^ft 4JJ1 -- •-' £r <,'>'' ,i' .-' •Mi ' - --^17 •>itf>-'.' . ^,i'>r if^ > ->< rr T^4- ^^iui^^J4tj5yVi4i?c; mmm as rt sing/e person .} means, His creation and resurrection of all of mankind on the Day of Resurrection is, in relation to His power, like the creation and resurrection of a single soul; all of this is easy for Him. J U*lt* j]3^ li| JO^I 4&JJZS jr % 3A 4Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is!} (36:82) ix^j vi ijil 4And Our commandment

is but one as the twinkling of an eye.) (54:50). This means He only has to command a thing once, and it will happen. There is no need for Him to repeat it or confirm it. A% i':W>% jt %> 4But it will be only a single ZajrahP] When behold, they find themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.} {79:13} 4^4 3 4Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} means, just as He hears all that they say, so He also sees all that they do, as if He is til See the Tafsir of Surat As-Saffat (37 : 19)

593Surah 31. Luqmati (29 - 30) (Part-21) hearing and seeing a single soul. His power over all of them is like His power over a single soul, Allah says: \$1 iThe creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only as a single person .) y 4 ^ j jfo * ' 'Sy t'Xf ' > s»\ 41 » < *Aft *" U 0»J < ' 1 o*J ^ 4. * ^ <>4 ji M^ 6j 429. See i/ow not that Allah merges the night into the day, and merges the day into the night, and has subjected the sun and the moon, each naming its course for a term appointed; and that Allah is All-Aware of what you do.) 430. That is because Allah, He is the Tmth, and that which they invoke besides Him is falsehood; and that Allah, He is the Most High, the Most Great> The Might and Power of Allah Allah tells us that He imerges the night into the day,) meaning, He takes from the night and adds to the day, so that the day becomes longer and the night shorter, which is what happens in summer when the days are longest; then the day starts to become shorter and the night longer, which is what happens in winter. <p d[xsj*y jliJ'j cP-il' iand has subjected the sun and the moon, each running its course for a tenn appointed;) It was said that this means, each runs within its set limits, or it means until the Day of Resurrection; both meanings are correct. The first view is supported by the Hadith of Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, in the Two Sahihs, according to which the Messenger of Allah said: q oJl& j. ; . ijj uf 4

595Surah 31. Luqman (31 - 32) (Part-21) Him, because everything in heaven and on earth is created by Him and is enslaved by Him; none of them could move even an atom's weight except with His permission. If all the people of heaven and earth were to come together to create a fly, they would not be able to do so. Allah says: 4CT.'."ijkJssJt -pj! jj 4»\ fj jJlL' 4jjJ U j* ii' ^That is because Allah, He is the Truth, and that which they invoke besides Him is falsehood; and that Allah, He is the Most High, the Most Great.} meaning, He is the Most High and there is none higher than Him, and He is the Most Great Who is greater than everything. Everything is subjugated and insignificant in comparison to Him. Ji a -4 3 & !£ p jls ^ jZjt. i>> JP' 431 . See you not that the ships sail through the sea by Allah's grace that He may show you of His signs? Verily, in this are signs for every patient, grateful (person).} 432 . And when waves cover them like shades, they invoke Allah, making their invocations for Him only. But when He brings them safe to land, there are among them those that stop in between. And Our Ayat are not denied except by every KhattSr Kafur.} Allah tells us that He is the One Who has subjugated the sea so that ships may sail on it by His command, i.e., by His grace and power. For if He did not give the water the strength to carry the ships, they would not sail. So he says: 44s4* Sippy {that He may show you of His signs} meaning, by His power. 4yjS. P, *3? 4 dSy {Verily, in this are signs for every patient, grateful.} means, every person who bears difficulty with patience and

597Surah 31. Lucjman (33 - 34) (Part-21) iKafur means, one who denies blessings and does not give thanks for them, rather he forgets them and does not remember them. o & i' -i; *& ^ it £ all* ^ it ^ <33 . 0 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord, and fear a Day when no father can avail aught for his son, nor a son avail aught for his father. Verily, the promise of Allah is true, let not then this present life

deceive you, nor let the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah. The Command to fear Allah and remember the Day of Resurrection Here Allah warns people about the Day of Resurrection, and commands them to fear Him and remember the Day of Resurrection when a father can avail nothing for his son, which means, even if he wanted to offer himself as a sacrifice for his son, it would not be accepted from him. The same will apply in the case of a son who wants to sacrifice himself for his father - it will not be accepted from him. Then Allah reminds them once again with the words: 'Do not let this present life deceive you,' meaning, do not let your feelings of contentment with this life make you forget about the Hereafter. 'Do not let the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah.' refers to the Shaytan. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah. ' The Shaytan makes man at-Tabari 20 : 159

promises to them and arouses in them false desires, but there is no substance to them, as Allah says: 'He makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.' (4 :120). Wahb bin Munabbih said: 'Uzayr, peace be upon him, said: "When I saw the misfortune of my people, I felt very sad and distressed, and I could not sleep, so I prayed to my Lord and fasted, and I called upon Him weeping. There came to me an angel and I said to him: Tell me, will the souls of the righteous intercede for the wrongdoers, or the fathers for their sons?" He said: 'On the Day of Resurrection all matters will be settled, and Allah's dominion will be made manifest and no exceptions will be made. No one will speak on that Day except with the permission of the Most Merciful. No father will answer for his son, or any son for his father, or any man for his brother, or any servant for his master. No one will care about anybody except himself, or feel grief or compassion for anyone except himself. Everyone will be worried only about himself. No one will be asked about anybody else. Each person will be concerned only about himself, weeping for himself and carrying his own burden. No one will carry the burden of another.' " This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. 'Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. No person knows what he will earn tomorrow, and no person knows in what land he will die. Verily, Allah is All-Knower, All-Aware.' The Knower of the Unseen is Allah These are the keys of the Unseen, whose knowledge Allah alone has kept for Himself, and no one else knows them unless Allah tells him about them. The knowledge of "when the Hour will occur" is not known to any Prophet who was sent or any angel who is close to Allah.

None can reveal its time but He (7:187). Similarly, no one but Allah knows when rain will fall, but when He issues the commands, the angels who are entrusted with the task of bringing rain know about it, as do those among His creation whom He wills should know. No one but He knows what is in the wombs of what He wants to create, but when He decrees whether it is to be male or female, and whether it is to be blessed or doomed, the angels who are entrusted with that know about it, as do those among His creation whom He wills should know. No one knows what he will earn tomorrow with regard to this world or the Hereafter, and no person knows in what land he will die. in his own land or elsewhere, in some other land. No one knows this. This Ayah is like the Ayah, 'And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them but He.' (6:59) It was reported in the Sunnah that the above five things are called the Keys of the Unseen. Imam Ahmad recorded that Buraydah said that he heard the Messenger of Allah say: 'The five things which are called the Keys of the Unseen are: the knowledge of the Hour, the knowledge of what is in the wombs, the knowledge of what will befall tomorrow, the knowledge of what will befall in the future, and the knowledge of what will befall in the past.' (lit j] : iul VI V Cti jff tftj <SjJi Uj Ijc liU dyJ-3 Cj .jLyV' 5

t* >Lu aThere are five things which no one knows except Allah: 4 Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. No person knows what he will earn tomorrow, and no person knows in what land he will die. Verily, Allah is All-Knower, All-Aware.} n111 111 Ahmad 5:353.

£00— Tafsir Ibn Kathir The chain of narrators for this Hadith is Sahih, although they did not record it. The Hadith of Ibn ‘Umar Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Umar said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said: &— && pe fre 3t : Si i % V ZjJO. ^u;» C{j*» y_ki iTj-li be y—f^=a: liU j-ij JjA-j Uj j U ^Lu> “The Keys of the Unseen are five, which no one knows except Allah: 4 Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. No person knows what he will earn tomorrow, and no person knows in what land he will die. Verily, Allah is All-Knower, All-Aware.” This was recorded only by Al-Bukhari, which he narrated in the Book of the Rain Prayer in his Sahtih. [2i He also recorded it in his Tafsir with a different chain of narrators, stating that ‘Abdullah bin Umar said, “The Prophet said: “The Keys of the Unseen are five.”” Then he recited: <4 b Ji«j C-IS!’—Ijijj ieUll pc f-Uc Ci\} iVerily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. This too was recorded only by Al-Bukhari. The Hadith of Abu Hurayrah In his Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari narrated from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah ^ was standing before the people one day when a Ahmad 2 :24. Fath Al-Bari 2 :609 Fath Al-Bari8 :373

601 Surah 31. Luqman (34) (Part-21) man came to him and said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, what is Iman?’ He said: 4-*/4 lyty’j */j >*&’&>j jit lyfiY O’ oUjVh *iman is to believe in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers and in the meeting with Him, and to believe in the Resurrection in the Hereafter . He said: ‘O Messenger of Allah, what is Islam?’ He said: Ji’yj ‘pJCj ilili hjiz ‘jj Z>\ Jui: jl p^iVIH fl OLA*j ^ “Islam is to worship Allah Alone and not associate anything in worship with Him, to establish regular prayer, to pay the obligatory Zakah, and to fast in Ramadan .» He said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, what is Ihsan?’ He said: •illJ j p JkIS Jui: jf jU4>-V”|» “Ihsan is to worship Allah as if you see Him, and if you do not see Him, then He sees you . He said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, when will the Hour come?’ He said: oiJj lil :l*i>i;rii ji- j&j iJlIJl j* U Irf CrJJJ 015 lip i je Ill-ii l^Sj <iVl pis <>’ 6^ :Jii jYSi: V jJJ- ^ i^»i^M <j li iiju) “The one who is asked about it does not know more than the one who is asking, but I will tell you of some of its signs: when the servant woman gives birth to her mistress, that is one of its signs; when the barefoot and naked become leaders of the people, that is one of its signs. The timing of the Hour is one of the five things which no one knows except Allah: iVerily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs Then the man went away, and the Prophet jg said,

oBring him back to me.» They went to bring him back, but they could not find him. He said: ‘• uThat was a fibril who came to teach the people their religion .b’ 1 ’ It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari in the Book of Faith, and by Muslim with several chains of narration.¹² ’ We have discussed this at the beginning of our commentary on Al- Bukhari, where we mentioned at length some Hadiths narrated by the Commander of the faithful Tjmar bin Al-Khattab. These were recorded only by Muslim. o- iand no person knows in what land he will die.} Qatadah said, "There are some things which Allah has kept to Himself, and they are not known to any angel who is close to Him or any Prophet who was sent by

Him. pig iJUfr au' 0^ 4Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour,} no one among mankind knows when the Hour will come, in which year or month, or whether it will come at night or during the day. if Ji%} 4He sends down the rain,} and no one knows when rain will come, night or day. 4 ^ >jx,} iand knoios that which is in the ivombs.} No one knows what is in the wombs, male or female, red or black, or what it is. 4'jc 'iU JLii iSjXj iNo person knows what he will earn tomorrow,} whether it will be good or bad. You do not know, O son of Adam, when you will die. You might die tomorrow, you might 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :373 '2| Fath Al-Bari 1 :140, Muslim 1 :39.

603Surah 31. Luqman (34) (Part-21) be stricken by calamity tomorrow. 4CjyU Jfj o-i* ufjJi no person knows in what land he will die.} means, no person knows where his resting place will be, on the land or in the sea, on a plain or in the mountains. [1 * It says in the Hadith: J^>- JuP Jill a \ j\ lilt «//Allah wants to take a person's soul in a particular land, He will give him a reason to go there.^ In Al-Mu'jam Al-Kabir, Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded that Usamah bin Zayd said, “The Messenger of Allah said: Ifci Ji»- JIp *i~; ill lit ^Allah does not will that a person should die in a certain land but He gives him a reason to go there

Surah 32: As-Sajdah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4470–4483]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Alif Lam Mim As-Sajdah (Chapter - 32) Which was revealed in Maklugh The Virtues of Surah Alif Lam Mim As-Sajdah In the Book of the Friday prayer, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Prophet used to recite in Fajr on Fridays: iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of...}, As-Sajdah, and j-c-i, Has there not been over man . . .} Al-Insan (76). "1 * This was also recorded by Muslim.'2' Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said, "The Prophet would never sleep until he recited: t\o 0>*£ i>t*O2 ^ ^ ^ f'. > ~c -- •> [11 FathAI-Bdri2:438. Muslim 2:599.

606 Tafsir Ibt Kathir iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of...}, As-Sajdah, and «Ji^ tfjji iBlessed be He in Whose Hand is the dominion} Al-Mulk (67). "1 ' 5g>> P In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. y j? A/i i d 4° ££ tA *rtU ^ Jv >%* oi Jp <it ^ by J^rA- u? i>J' 43. Alif Lam Mim.} 42 . The revelation of the Book in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists.} 43. Or say they : "He has fabricated it?" Nay, it is the truth from your Lord, so that you may warn a people to whom no wamer has come before you, in order that they may be guided.} The Qur'an is the Book of Allah in which there is no Doubt We discussed the individual letters at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. 4The revelation of the Book in which there is no doubt,} means, there is no doubt whatsoever that it has been revealed ifrom the Lord of all that exists.} Then Allah tells us about the idolaters: }Or say they: "He has fabricated it?": they say, he has fabricated it, i.e., he has made it up by himself. m Ahmad 3:340.

4-^o-X-r. p-a-lj d&J oi jfi» cit |*i^ ^ £y» jxil. iNay, it is the truth from your Lord, so that you may warn a people to whom no wamer has come before you, in order that they may be guided.} means, in order that they may follow the truth. U Jryli Je lsy~7\ > frji ii_-. ^ l. Uj oyH)' jU- 4af^> JI <5* >'@SgS 53^ vj# *J> it .)(j jth* UJ (Jijt nJliL fji j ^4. Allah it is He Wlw has created the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them in six Days. Then He Istawa over the Throne. You have none, besides Him, as a protector or an intercessor. Will you not then remember?} 45. He directs the command from the heavens to the earth; then it will go up to Him, in one Day, the space whereof is a thousand years of your reckoning.} <6. That is He, the All-Knoiver of the unseen and the seen, the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} Allah is the Creator and Controller of the Universe Allah tells us that He is the Creator of all things. He created the heavens and earth and all that is between them in six days, then He rose over the Throne - we have already discussed this matter elsewhere. 'h >i> v, 0' f^C} 4You have none, besides Him, as a protector or an intercessor} means, only He is the Sovereign Who is in control of all affairs, the Creator of all things, the Controller of all things, the One Who is able to do all things. There is no

Creator besides Him, no intercessor except the one to whom He gives permission. See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf{7 :54)

609 Surah 32. As-Sajdah (7 - 9) (Part-21) 47. Who made everything He has created good and He began the creation of man from clay.} 48. Then He made his offspring from semen of despised water.} 49. Then He fashioned him in due proportion, and breathed into him the soul; and He gave you hearing, sight and the sense of deduction . Little is the thanks you give!} The Creation of Man in Stages Allah tells us that He has created everything well and formed everything in a goodly fashion. Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam: 4r-&- ft 4 Who made everything He has created good} means, "He created everything well and in a goodly fashion." When Allah mentions the creation of the heavens and the earth. He follows that by mentioning the creation of man. Allah says: irtf Jb- 4 and He began the creation of man from clay.} meaning, He created the father of mankind, Adam, from clay. 4 ft ft X** 'ft} 4 Then He made his offspring from semen of despised water.} means, they reproduce in this fashion, from a Nutfah which comes from the loins of men and from between the ribs of women. 4 Then He fashioned him in due proportion,} means, when He created Adam from clay. He created him and gave him shape and made him upright. 4 and breathed into him the soul; and He gave you hearing, sight and the sense of deduction.} means, reason.

610 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4 of SZ £ yJf} i Little is the thanks you give!} means, for these strengths with which Allah has provided you; the one who is truly blessed is the one who uses them to worship and obey his Lord, may He be exalted and glorified. ^ op't J52 410. And they say : "When we are lost in the earth, shall we indeed be created anew?" Nay, but they deny the meeting with their Lord!} ill. Say: "The angel of death, who is set over you, will take your souls. Then you shall be brought to your Lord."} Refutation of Those Who think the Resurrection is unlikely to happen Allah tells us how the idolaters thought it unlikely that the resurrection would ever come to pass, and how they said: 4<J*\$ 4 4 Wheti we are lost in the earth,} meaning, "when our bodies have been scattered and have disintegrated and dispersed in the earth," #JVb 4 shall we indeed be created anew?} means, 'after that, will we come back again?' They thought it unlikely that this would happen, and in terms of their own feeble abilities it is indeed unlikely, but this is not the case with regard to the power of the One Who created them from nothing. Who when He wills a thing merely says to it, "Be!" and it is. Allah says: fro «3£ 4 Nay, but they deny the meeting with their Lord!} Then Allah says: 4f£> So 4\$ 4^ 4 Say: "The angel of death, who is set over you, will take your

' souls...") The a PP ar ent > , ^ meaning of this At/ah is that the angel of death j* a spec'f'c f ^ ^ x - iZi- personality among the (jp angels, as is also " > -- <,i,r< > V' »^r"i * > <>-' :***: apparent from the Vadh of A1 -Bara' ^ jij which we quoted in \>l >A' fa-'*' <our Tafsir °f) Sarah Ibrahim .^ 1 In some TMp»rts he (the angel » ^ " I » ~ nf apflth is rallpfi ? r ? > 1 I * 4 * > -Lr- ' 9 m ~ > - i > ~ of death) is called u-i_? gpUaJ l/- Izrail, which is well rf" - yf«e. t-try je»tr>T*rvir<^i " i. * known. This is the ^ view of Qatadah and v —rc7~<-^; <J " J" • view of Qatadah and others. The angel of "• " t death has helpers. It was reported in the Hadith that his , y -tX , ^ helpers draw out the soul from the rest of the bod» •» j__^_ ' i reaches the throat, then the angel of death takes it. Mujahid said, "The earth is brought together for him and it is like a platter from which he takes whenever he wants."*3 4& i Then you shall be brought to your Lord.) means, on the Day when you are resurrected and brought forth from your

graves to receive your reward or punishment. LI^>U l. r*i) -e* [y-^ * 5? P> V&i & jji't <> 33J £H tS4 -)j q Ctu See volume live , the TafslrofSurah Ibrahim (14 :27) * At-Tabari 20:175. At-Tabari 20:175.

llj bbj* Up& JV» 4\$^ IL ili> <12. And if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} 413. And ifWe had willed, surely We would have given every person his guidance, but the Word from Me took effect, that I will fill Hell with Jinn and mankind together.} 414. Then taste because of your forgetting the meeting of this Day of yours. Surely, We too will forget you, so taste you the abiding tormentfor what you used to do.} The Bad State inwhich the Idolaters willbe on the Day ofResurrection Allah tells us the state of the idolators on the Day of Resurrection and what they will say when they see the Resurrection and are standing before Allah - may He be glorified - humiliated and brought low, with their heads bowed, i.e., in shame. They will say: XZJ} 40ur Lord! We have now seen and heard,} meaning, 'now we hear what You say and we will obey You.' This is like the Ayah, 4How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us!} (19:38). And they will blame themselves when they enter the Fire, and will say: jj GS" & ,Jiu jl IS" fi} 4"Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!"} (67:10) Similarly, here they are described as saying:

613Surah 32. As-Sajdah (12 - 14) (Part-21) iOur Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back} to the world, Ay 1*4-^ 4that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty.} means, how we are sure and we believe that Your promise is true and that the meeting with You is true.' But the Lord, may He be exalted, knows that if He were to send them back to this world, they would behave as they did previously, and they would reject and disbelieve in the signs of Allah and would go against His Messengers, as He says: Vj Lli ijliiM i^jJ Tij fj} iff you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the AySt ofour Lord,"} (6: 27) And Allah says here: 414^0* y Ci4 \$j} 4And if We had willed, surely We would have given every person his guidance,} This is like the Ayah, i^Jr cgyVf 4^ 4j 4And had your Lord willed, tlwse on earth would have believed, all ofthem together} (10:99). ibut the Word from Me took effect, that I will fill Hell with Jinn and mankind together.} i.e., from both classes, so their abode will be Hell and they will have no escape from it and no way out. We seek refuge with Allah and in His perfect Words from that. ££ sSj ^4 C iThen taste because ofyour forgetting the meeting of this Day ofyours.} means, it will be said to the people of Hell by way of rebuke:

The State ofthe People ofFaith and Their Reward Allah states: (1\) iOnly those believe in Our Aydt,) means, who accept them as true, <r, 'k ctjty iwho, when they are reminded of them, fall down prostrate,) means, they listen to them and obey them in word and deed. icw& V pfi iand glorify the praises of their Lord, and they are not proud.) means, they are not too proud to follow them and submit to them, unlike the ignorant among the rebellious disbelievers. Allah says: iVerily, those who scorn My worship, they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!) (40:60). Then Allah says: ig&J\ ji iTheir sides forsake their beds,) meaning, they pray the voluntaxy night prayer and forego sleep and resting on a comfortable bed. Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that the Ayah iTheir sides forsake their beds,) refers to voluntary night prayer.111 Ad-Dahhak said, "It refers to Salat Al-'lsha' in congrega- tion and Salat Al-Fajr in

congregation pr,j) ito invoke their Lord in fear and hope,) means, in fear of His punishment and in hope of His reward. iL^j) iand they spend out of what We have bestowed on than.) in At-Jabari 20 :180

616 TafsTr Ibn Kathir means, they do both obligatory and supererogatory acts of worship. Their leader in this world and the Hereafter is the Messenger of Allah jg. Imam Ahmad recorded that Mu'adh bin Jabal said, "I was with the Messenger of Allah sg on a journey one morning, walking near him. I said, 'O Prophet of Allah, tell me of a deed that will grant me admittance to Paradise and keep me away from Hell.' He said: 2ii -L*; 2ii ojijj ^__il 213 cJLi jjj» * •tS'jJl 4 till «Yom have asked about something great, and it is easy for the one for whom Allah makes it easy. Worship Allah and do not associate anything with Him, establish regular prayer, pay Zakah, fast Ramadan and perform pilgrimage to the House. Then he said: i-cJiiJl iijJaJlj t£>- «-jlyr i kiljff Vf® "JP J 0Shall I not tell you of the gates of goodness? Fasting is a shield, charity wipes out sin, and the prayer of a man in the depths of the night. Then he recited: ft (4iff. ji'<£} iTheir sidesforsake their beds,} until he reached 4\$Z IL%} ias a rewardfor what they used to do.} Then he said: iJJiJ 5 tShall I not tell you of the greatest of all things and its pillars and pinnacle? I said, 'Of course, O Messenger of Allah.' He said: Js-" ft ^iSfl f^j *The greatest of all things is Islam, its pillars are the prayers

617 Surah 32. As-Saidah (15 -17) (Part-21) and its pinnacle is Jihadfor the sake of Allah. Then he said: iui^ h'J.\ » iShall I not tell you the factor on which all of that depends?» I said, 'Of course, O Messenger of Allah.' He took hold of his tongue and said, <IJla JJQp ,1iS «Restrain this.* I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, will we be accountable for what we say?' He said, iU :Ji* jt - 'rtfrj^ jilJi j It ciui u ^ •» > s # ' . 1*1 ./>» y>~ «M«/ your mother be bereft of you, O Mu'adh! Will the people be thrown into Hell - (or he said) on their faces - except because of what their tongues say?® It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Mdjah in their Sunans. At-Tirmidhi said, "It is Hasan Sahthu"|21 4\$ 'O P liP 2 J12 vft 4No person knows what is kept hidden for them of delights of eyes» means, no one knows the vastness of what Allah has concealed for them of everlasting joy in Paradise and delights such as no one has ever seen. Because they conceal their good deeds, Allah conceals the reward for them, a fitting reward which will suit their deeds. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "If people conceal their good deeds, Allah will conceal for them what no eye has seen and what has never crossed the mind of man. It was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Al-Bukhari quoted the Ayah: 4No person knows what is kept hidden for than of delights of eyes» 111 Ahmad 5:231. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :361 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :428, Ibn Majah 2:i314.

Then he recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: ill Jli» Vj^ hl\ Nj «_~b JjIp says: "J have prepared for My right- eous servants what no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and it has never crossed the mind of man Abu Hurayrah said: "Recite, if you wish: 4yd 'C* oifd 4No version knows

what is kept hidden for them of delights of eyes.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4483–4494]

It was also recorded by Muslim and At-Tirmidhi. At-Tirmidhi said, "It is Hasan Sahth.. "21 In another version of Al-Bukhari: u al; jt ^ JU l"and no body has ever even imagined of. All that is reserved,

besides which, all that you have seen is nothing.” It was also reported from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Prophet ﷺ said: 111 Path Al-Bari 8 :375 Muslim 4 :2174 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi9 :56

Whoever enters Paradise, will enjoy a life of luxury and never feel deprivation, his clothes will never wear out, his youth will never fade. In Paradise there is what no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, and has never crossed the mind of man. This was recorded by Muslim . P+u '>>' i/& 0 V l_L.ll if \jg J 1? jfr ;&Jt* c# ijb'> .aj tfjll jL23' ^ ^ d-U If* 1^ V~iW (ji1 <>*J .jjJ i-j'jji <38. Is then he who is a believer like him who is rebellious? Not equal are they.) <39. As for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them are Gardens of Abode as an entertainment for what they used to do.) <20. And as for those who rebel, their abode will be the Fire, every time they wish to get away therefrom, they will be put back thereto, and it will be said to them: "Taste you the torment of the Fire which you used to deny.") <21. And verily, We will make them taste of the near lighter torment prior to the greater torment, in order that they may return.) <22 . And who does more wrong than he who is reminded of the Ayat of his Lord, then turns aside therefrom? Verily, We shall exact retribution from the criminals.) The Believer and the Rebellious are not equal Allah tells us that in His justice and generosity, on the Day of Judgement He will not judge those who believed in His signs and followed His Messengers, in the same way as He will judge 111 At-Tabari 20:186, Muslim 4:2181

620 Tafsir Ibn Kathir those who rebelled, disobeyed Him and rejected the Messengers sent by Allah to them. This is like the Ayat [pK Lpfas Jfccc J Up 'f- '^} £ '•& pr££j iOr do those who earn evil deeds think that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds, in their present life and after their death? Worst is the judgement that they make.] (45:21), ifliijl fp >1 dfj£\ 4 eg .iJK' iShall We treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds as corruptors on earth? Or shall We treat those who have Taqwa as the wicked?} (38:28) iNot equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. . . } (59:20). Allah says: v uL-G ils then he who is a believer like him who is a rebellious? Not equal are they.} i.e., before Allah on the Day of Resurrection. ‘Ata’ bin Yasar, As-Suddi and others mentioned that this was revealed concerning ‘Ali bin Abi Tahb and TjQBah bin Abi MuTtJ Hence Allah has judged between them when He said: Ji \&j ip: iM &} }Asfar those who believe and do righteous good deeds,} meaning, their hearts believed in the signs of Allah, and they did as the signs of Allah dictate, i.e. righteous good deeds. ifar them are Gardens ofAbode} i.e., in which there are dwellings IM At-Tabari 20:188.

621 Surah 32. As-Sajdah (18 - 22) (Part-21) and houses and lofty apartments. /N\4^A 4<is <m entertainment means, something to welcome and honor a guest. ill; ££ <(/br ivfiat they used to do. And as for those who rebel,} means, those who disobeyed Allah, their dwelling place will be the Fire, and every time they want to escape from it, they will be thrown back in, as Allah says: iEvery time they seek to get away therefrom, from anguish, they will be driven back therein} (22:22). Al-Fudayl bin Iyad said: “By Allah, their hands will be tied, their feet will be chained, the flames will lift them up and the angels will strike them. ii .4.^ ^ iand it will be said to them : "Taste you the torment of the Fire which you used to deny."}" means, this will be said to them by way of rebuke and chastisement. ytiJi sj» vuji << 4And verily, We will make them taste of the near lighter torment prior to the greater torment,} Ibn

‘Abbas said, “The near torment means diseases and problems in this world, and the things that happen to its people as a test from Allah to His servants so that they will repent to Him.” ‘ Something similar was also narrated from Ubayy bin KaTa, Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Al-Hasan, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Alqamah, ‘Atiyah, Mujahid, Qatadah, ‘Abd Al- Karim Al-Jazari and Khusayf.*2 ‘ [11 At-Tabari 20:189. 121 At-Tabari 20 : 189 , 190

623Surah 32. As-Sajdah (23 - 25) (Part-21) narrated that Abu Al-‘Aliyah Ar-Riyahi said, “The cousin of your Prophet, meaning Ibn ‘Abbas, told me that the Messenger of Allah igs said: Jlij ljuo- {ji hL. J! IrrZ «JL?.jJI3 jllJl OjU- l&U «On the night of Isra', I saw Musa bin ‘Imran, a tall, brown- skinned man with curly hair, looking like the men of Shani'ah; and I saw 'Isa, a man ofmedium stature and ruddy white skin, and with lank hair. And I saw Malik the Keeper of Hell, and the Dajjal .» Among the signs which Allah showed him were: oi hs, 4 o^~3 <\$So, be not you in doubt of meeting him .} i.e., he saw Musa and met with him on the Night of Isra’.” 4*&*o} iAnd We made it} means, *theBookwhichWe gave to him,’ 4a guide to the Children of Israel.} This is similar to what Allah says in Surat Al-Isra 4ff'/'^~=,j jJi ot x0, ts“j 4And We gave Musa the Scripture and made it a guidance for the Children of Israel (saying) • “Take none other than Me as Trustee.”} (17:2) lijji \y£=>J Cj li^l 4And We made from among than, leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient and used to believe with certainty in OurAyat.} means, because they were patient in adhering to the commands of Allah and avoiding what He prohibited, and they m At-Jabari 20:194.

believed in His Messengers and followed what they brought, there were among them leaders who guided others to the truth by the command of Allah, calling for goodness, enjoining what is right and forbidding what is wrong. Then when they changed [the Words of Allah], twisting and distorting them, they lost that position and their hearts became hard. They change the words from their places, so they do no righteous deeds and have no correct beliefs. Allah says: iAnd We madefrom among them (Children of Israel), leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient> Qatadah and Sufyan said: “When they patiently shunned the temptations of this world.” This was also the view of Al-Hasan bin Salih. Sufyan said, “This is how these people were. A man cannot be an example to be followed unless he shuns the temptation of this world.” Allah says: <J? ft&m ^Ar\ iAnd indeed We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, and the understanding of the Scripture and its laws, and the prophethood; and provided them with good things, and preferred them above the nations. And We gave them clear proofs in matters.> (45:16-17). And He says here: llj jyj ft iVerily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection, concerning that wherein they used to differ. meaning, with regard to beliefs and actions. 4 ft^r--* 4 &Jr~l <ix£& Oi V, ££=& ft ft ft; ft * ji S0 (Sf ftf \$3 iftk ftSZ~jUi i26. Is it not a guidance for them: how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they do walk about? Verily, therein indeed are signs. Would they not then

625Surah 32. As-Sajdah (26 - 27) (Part-21) listen?} 427. Have they not seen how We drive water to the dry land that has no vegetation, and therewith bring forth crops providing food for their cattle and themselves? Will they not then see?} Learning the Lessons ofthe Past Allah says: will these people who deny the Messengers not learn from the nations who came before them, whom Allah destroyed for their rejection of His Messengers and their opposition to what the Messengers brought them of the straight path? No trace is left of them whatsoever. iCan you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of

them?} (19:98). Allah says: 4 VrZ) iin whose dwellings they do walk about} meaning, these disbelievers walk about in the places where those disbelievers used to live, but they do not see any of those who used to live there, for they have gone - 4-As if they had never lived there} (1 1:68) This is like the Ayat iThese are their houses in utter ruin, for they did wrong} (27:52). j * *-* • * <"<} S mss iAnd many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins, and (many) a deserted well and lofty castle! Have they not traveled through the land} until:

627Surah 32. As-Sajdah (28 - 30) (Part-21) foodfor their cattle and themselves? Will they not then see?} This is like the Ayah, iThen let man look at his food: We pour forth water in abundance.} (80:24-25). Allah says here: tWill they not then see?}viii tiic-if iii/i mc-M y \xji£ J;j3' *5/ gLiJ' j>J> ji ^i=s> o) ^ 428. They say: "Wlien will this Fath be, ifyou are telling the truth?"} 429. Say: "On the Day ofAl-Fath, no profit will it be to those who disbelieve if they (then) believe! Nor will they be granted a respite."} 430. So turn asidefrom them and await, verily, they (too) are awaiting.}

How the Disbelievers sought to hasten on the Punishment, andwhat happened toThem Allah tells us how the disbelievers sought to hasten on the punishment, and to bring the wrath and vengeance of Allah upon themselves, because they thought this punishment would never happen, and because of their disbelief and stubbornness. 4££_i)('ii& <£>)&} 4They say: "When will this Fath be..."} meaning, *when will you prevail over us, O Muhammad, since you claim that there will be a time when you will gain the upper hand over us and take your revenge on us, so when will that happen? All we see of you and your companions is that you are hiding, afraid and humiliated.' Allah says: 4Say : "On the Day of Al-Fath..."} meaning, \when the wrath

629Surah 32. As-Sajdah (28 - 30) (Part-21) over those who disbelieved (2 :89) ilfyou askfor a judgment, now has the judgment come unto you} (8 :19). Then Allah says: (Hpi 4So ft/m aside from thm and await, verily, they (too) are awaiting.} meaning, "turn away from these idolators, and convey that which has been revealed to you from your Lord.' This is like the Ayah, iFollow what has been revealed to you from your Lord, there is no God but Him.} (6 :106) Wait until Allah fulfills that which He has promised you, and grants you victory over those who oppose you, for He never breaks His promise.' ^i} iverily, they (too) are awaiting.} means, *you are waiting, and they are waiting and plotting against you,' p i*f f \K'A <-*) ** Q*IJ* J*;U OJj iOr do they say : "A poet! We awaitfor him some calamity by time!"} (52 :30). "You will see the consequences of your patience towards them, and the fulfillment of the promise of your Lord in your victoiy over them, and they will see the consequences of their wait for something bad to befall you and your Companions, in that Allah's punishment will come upon them.' Sufficient unto us is Allah, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs.

Surah 33: Al-Ahzab

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4495–4515]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Ahzab (Chapter - 33) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah. Prophet! Have Taqwa of Allah, and obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise. And follow that which is revealed to you [from your Lord. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.] And put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.

The Command to defy the Disbelievers and Hypocrites by following the Revelation of Allah and putting One's Trust in Him. Here Allah points out something lower by referring to something higher. When He commands His servant and Messenger to do this, He is also commanding those who are lower than him, and the command is addressed to them more so. Talq bin Habib said: "Taqwa means obeying Allah in the light of the guidance of Allah and in hope of earning the reward of Allah, and refraining from disobeying Allah in the light of the guidance of Allah and fearing the punishment of Allah." i.e., obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites. means, do not listen to what they say and do not consult them. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise means, He is more deserving of your following His commandments and obeying Him, for He knows the consequences of all things and is Wise in all that He says and does. Allah says: And follow that which is revealed to you from your Lord. meaning, of the Qur'an and Sunnah. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do. means, nothing at all is hidden from Him, and put your trust in Allah, i.e., in all your affairs and situations. and sufficient is Allah as a Wakil. means, sufficient is He as a Trustee for the one who puts his trust in Him and turns to Him.

Neither has Allah made for any man two hearts inside his body. Neither has He made your wives whom you declare to be like your mothers' backs, your real mothers nor has He made your adopted sons your real sons. That is but your saying with your mouths. But Allah says the truth, and He guides to the way. Call them by their fathers, that is more just with Allah. But if you know not their father's, your brothers in faith and Mawalikum (your freed servants). And there is no sin on you concerning that in which you made a mistake, except in regard to what your hearts deliberately intend. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Abolition of Adoption Before Allah discusses ideas and theoretical matters. He gives tangible examples: one man cannot have two hearts in his body, and a man's wife does not become his mother if he says the words of Zihar to her: "You are to me like the back of my mother." By the same token, an adopted child does not become the son of the man who adopts him and calls him his

son. Allah says: ifrt J-"!- • ris li'i u iAllah has not made for any man two hearts inside his body. Neither has He made your wives whom you declare to be like your mothers' backs, your real mothers...} This is like the Ayah: iThey cannot be their mothers. None can be their mothers except those who gave them birth} (58:2). Cj}

inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} This was revealed concerning Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, the freed servant of the Prophet sg|. The Prophet j^5 had adopted him before prophethood, and he was known as Zayd bin Muhammad. Allah wanted to put an end to this naming and attribution, as He said: Cj} inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} This is similar to the Ayah later in this Surah: ill' dff) Oi U -ui \}) iMuhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last (end) of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.} (33:40). And Allah says here: iThat is but your saying with your mouths.} meaning, "your adoption of him is just words, and it does not mean that he is really your son," for he was created from the loins of another man, and a child cannot have two fathers just as a man cannot have two hearts in one body. j>:%} iBut Allah says the truth, and He guides to the way.} Said bin Jubayr said: iBut Allah says the truth,} means, justice. Qatadah said: %} iand He guides to the way} means, the straight path. Imam Ahmad said that Hasan told them that Zuhayr told them from QabUs, meaning Ibn Abi Zibyan, that his father told him: "I said to Ibn 'Abbas, TDo you know the Ayah,

iAllah has not made for any man two hearts inside his body What does this mean?' He said that the Messenger of Allah jg stood up one day to pray, and he trembled. The hypocrites who were praying with him said, *Do you not see that he has two hearts, one heart with you and another with them?' Then Allah revealed the words: 4 >5^ £ J '*>? iAllah has not made for any man two hearts inside his body.)'*" This was also narrated by At-Tirmidhi, who said, "It is a Hasan Hadith".*21 It was also narrated by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim from the Hadith of Zuhayr. 131 An Adopted Child should be named after His Real Father If; Jii! fk iCall them (adopted sons) by their fathers, that is more just with Allah> This is a command which abrogates the state of affairs that existed at the beginning of Islam, when it was permitted to call adopted sons after the man who adopted them. Then Allah commanded that they should be given back the names of their real fathers, and states that this was more fair and just. Al- Bukhari (may Allah have mercy on him) narrated that 'Abdullah bin Umar said: "Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, the freed servant of the Messenger of Allah 5§. was always called Zayd bin Muhammad, until (the words of the) Qur'an were revealed: & ifU iCall them (adopted sons) by (the names of) their fathers, that is more just with Allah. Ahmad 1 :267. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :58 ^ Ahmad, no. 2410 and At-Tabari 20:204. Most of the scholars of Hadith consider the chain of narrators for this text to be defective. 141 FathAl-Bari 8:377.

Sarah 33 . Al-Ahzab (4 - 5) (Part-21 As for calling a person "son" as an expression of honor and endearment, this is not what is forbidden in this Ayah, as is indicated by the report recorded by Imam Ahmad and the Sunan compilers - apart from At-Tirmidhi - from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: "We young boys of Banu 'Abd Al-Muttalib came to the Messenger of Allah sg at the Jamarat, he slapped us on the thigh and said, «0 my sons, do not stone the Jamarah until the sun has risen .*' 11 This was during the Farewell Pilgrimage in 10 AH. iCall them by their fathers .> This is concerning Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him. He was killed in 8 AH at the battle of

Mu'tah. In Sahih Muslim it is reported that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "The Messenger of Allah said: «O my son.»" It was also reported by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi.¹³ But if you know not their father's then they are your brothers in the religion and Mawalikum (your freed servants). Here Allah commands that adopted sons should be given back their fathers' names, if they are known; if they are not known, then they should be called brothers in faith or freed servants, to compensate for not knowing what their real lineage is. When the Messenger of Allah^ﷺ left Makkah after performing his 'Umrat Al-Qada', 141 the daughter of Hamzah, may Allah 111 Ahmad 1:234, Abu Dawud 2:480, An-NasAl 5:271, Ibn MSjah * Muslim 3 :1693 131 Abu Dawud 5 :247 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :120 141 This was the 'Umrah performed by the Prophet gg in the year following Al-Hudaybiyah (6 H) when he had been prevented from performing 'Umrah as he had intended

your brothers in faith and your freed servants. Then Allah says: i.h Li ££ ^And there is no sin on you concerning that in which you made a mistake,} meaning, if you call one of them after someone who is not in fact his father, by mistake, after hying your best to find out his parentage, then Allah will not attach any sin to this mistake. This is like the Ayah in which Allah commands His servants to say: < iOur Lord! Punish us not if we forget or fall into error} (2:286). It was reported in Sahih Muslim that the Messenger of Allah jg Sa^' _ * [-? •; . - ' s ' >i I 'tiS, ju : J>-j I Jli» «Allah says, "Certainly I did (so)."" In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it was recorded that 'Amr bin Al-'As, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "The Messenger of Allah jg said: \ <ij (Liti i(T-^l jjj <j\y~ l <1* . > U ^UJl XfJr 1 Ijji «// the judge makes ljtild and reaches the right decision, he will have two rewards; if he makes Ijtihad and reaches the wrong decision, he will have one reward.»|2) In another Hadith: ®<-L Uj jLwJlj IkiJl ^*1 jp <ul tl)| ® *Allah will forgive my Ummah for mistakes, forgetfulness and what they are forced to doJ|31 And Allah says here: &Z & ojL3 i2 Li s\$} 4l»5 Muslim 1 : 1 16 ^ Path Al-Bari 13 :330. Ijtihad means "struggles." ^ TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 1 :659

640 Tafstr Ibn Kathir \$And there is no sin on you concerning that in which you made a mistake, except in regard to what your hearts deliberately intend. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} meaning, the sin is on the person who deliberately does something wrong, as Allah says elsewhere: ifcrt -j ^ iAlliih will not call you to account for that which is unintentional in your oaths} (2:225). Imam Ahmad narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that "Umar said: "Allah sent Muhammad j§ with the Truth and revealed to him the Book. One of the things that was revealed in it was the Ayah of stoning, so the Messenger of Allah jg stoned [adulterers] and we stoned [them] after he died." Then he said, "We also used to recite, 'Do not attribute yourselves to anyone other than your fathers, for this is disbelief, to attribute yourselves to anyone other than your fathers.'" The Messenger of Allah si said: ijbi <£• 'j,\ ui jjp <<j , : it «Do not exaggerate in praising me as 'Isa bin Maryam was praised upon him be peace and blessings. I am just a servant of Allah. Say, "He is His servant and Messenger .»" Or Ma'mar may have said: 5ji ^u-ji o>t "As the Christians praised the son of Maryam.»[1 ' This was also narrated in another Hadith: Jz Udijj cv-iSJij yLii :)& j «Three things that people do are parts of disbelief: slandering a person's lineage, wailing over the dead and seeking rain by the stars, n*21 t1 ' Ahmad 1 :47. Muslim No. 934, Ahmad 5:342

bljSj (*r ;4^ 'r-ih o; cntl-lij -ciL^=> ZJJ J S;^ 4-.vCjJl*— • ^ 46. The Prophet is closer to the believers than themselves, and his wives are their mothers. And blood relations among each other have closer

personal ties in the decree of Allah than the believers and the Muhajirin, except that you do kindness to those brothers. This has been written in the Book.} Loyalty to the Prophet and his wives are Mothers of the Believers Allah tells us how His Messenger is merciful and sincere towards his Ummah, and how he is closer to them than they are to themselves. His judgement or ruling takes precedence over their own choices for themselves, as Allah says: *ft ---*1' tj !>*-£ j r >*-H!* 4But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them, and find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept with full submission.} (4:65) In the Sahih it says: *5fi'/j^j In J*- cn& V i-hi Ijr* iSWj* «By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, none of you tridy believes until I am dearer to him than his own self, his wealth, his children and all the people.^ It was also reported in the SahVi that Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “O Messenger of Allah, by Allah, you are dearer to me than everything except myself.” He said, *jy. idj bj\ JU- Vjj. u t m Fath Al-Bari 1 :75.*

}And blood relations among each other have closer personal ties in the decree of Allah than the believers and the MuhdjirTn,} This is an abrogation of the rule that existed previously, whereby they could inherit from one another by virtue of the oath of brotherhood among them. Ibn ‘Abbas and others said: “A Muhajir would inherit from an Ansari even though they were not related by blood, because of the brotherhood established between them by the Messenger of Allah This was also stated by Said bin Jubayr and others among scholars of the earlier and later generations. iexcept that you do kindness to those brothers.} means, the idea of inheriting from one another has gone, but there remains the duty to offer support and kindness, to uphold ties of brotherhood and to offer good advice. iThis has been written in the Book.} This ruling, which is that those who are blood relatives have closer personal ties to one y’}ji (ptpalWL yy y y *’’*’ *’’*’’A\\y*y ./ <a.’: 111 Al-Bukhari nos. 2292, 4580, 6747.

ijyj ftHii LJ £Sj)l» ~-j -ii ts°J 0\$ (yt 4±e,)syti ij ii*’ !A\$ 3 4He (Allah) has ordained far you the same religion which He ordainedfar Nuh, and that which We have revealed to you, and that which We ordainedfar Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it.} (42:13) This is the covenant which Allah took from them, as He says: *J-*j <yA> gj jp <>#’ &^* 4And when We took from the Prophets their covenant, and from you, and from Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa, and isa son of Maryam .} This Ayah begins with the last Prophet, as a token of respect, may the blessings of Allah be upon him, then the names of the other Prophets are given in order, may the blessings of Allah be upon them. Ibn ‘Abbas said: “The strong covenant is Al-'Ahd (the covenant). 0* &3} iThat He may ask the truthful about their truth.} Mujahid said: “This refers to, those who convey the Message from the Messengers. ”*2 ' ^ji} 4And He has prepared far the disbelievers} i.e., among then- nations, iCi| <&.) 4a painful torment.} i.e., agonizing. We bear witness that the Messengers did indeed convey the Message of their Lord and advised their nations, and that they clearly showed them the truth in which there is no confusion, doubt or ambiguity, even though they were rejected by the ignorant, stubborn and rebellious wrongdoers. What the 111 At-Tabari 20:213. 121 Al-Tabari 20:214.

646 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Messengers brought is the truth, and whoever opposes them is misguided. As the people of Paradise will say: *c;& %}* 4Indeed , the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth.} (7:43) *p %y& pit ii ^ \jx \$£> j(j ~pt inj pj Jt fit H djtu t ii' ktjy 4tl0S\ pi ojij 'j#2& 4^f j£#T y-* 49. O you who believe! Remember Allah’s favor to you, when there came against you hosts, and We sent against them a wind and forces that you saw not. And Allah is Ever All-Seer of what you do.} 410.

When they came upon you from above you and from below you, and when the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} The Campaign of the Confederates (Al-Ahzab) Allah tells us of the blessings and favors He bestowed upon His believing servants when He diverted their enemies and defeated them in the year when they gathered together and plotted. That was the year of Al-Khandaq, in Shawwal of the year 5 AH according to the well-known correct view. Musa bin Tjubah and others said that it was in the year 4 AH. The reason why the Confederates came was that a group of the leaders of the Jews of Banu Nadir, whom the Messenger of Allah jg had expelled from Al-Madinah to Khaybar, including Sallam bin Abu Al-Huqayq, Sailam bin Mishkam and Kinanah bin Ar-Rabr, went to Makkah where they met with the leaders of Quraysh and incited them to make war against the Prophet. They promised that they would give them help and support, and Quraysh agreed to that. Then they went to the Ghatafan tribe with the same call, and they responded too. The Quraysh came out with their company of men from various tribes and their followers, under the leadership of Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb. The Ghatafan were led by Tjyaynah bin Hisn bin Badr. In all they numbered nearly ten thousand.

647 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (9 - 10) (Part-21 When the Messenger of Allah jg heard that they had set out, he commanded the Muslims to dig a ditch (Khandaq) around Al-Madinah from the east. This was on the advice of Salman Al-Farisi, may Allah be pleased with him. So the Muslims did this, working hard, and the Messenger of Allah sg worked with them, carrying earth away and digging, in the process of which there occurred many miracles and clear signs. The idolators came and made camp to the north of Al-Madinah, near Uhud, and some of them camped on the high ground overlooking Al-Madinah, as Allah says: i'f-t Jt fS&r iWlien they came upon you from above you and from below you) The Messenger of Allah jg came out with the believers, who numbered nearly three thousand, or it was said that they numbered seven hundred. They had their backs towards (the mountain of) Sal' and were facing the enemy, and the ditch, in which there was no water, was between the two groups, preventing the cavalry and infantry from reaching them. The women and children were in the strongholds of Al-Madinah. Banu Qurayzah, who were a group among the Jews, had a fortress in the south-east of Al-Madinah, and they had made a treaty with the Prophet and were under his protection. They numbered nearly eight hundred fighters. Huyay bin Akhtab An-Nadari went to them and kept trying to persuade them until they broke the treaty and went over to the side of the Confederates against the Messenger of Allah jg. The crisis deepened and things got worse, as Allah says: yii; iThrcr, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking) [33: 11] They besieged the Prophet jg and his Companions for almost a month, but they did not reach them and there was no fighting between them, except for when 'Amr bin 'Abd Wadd Al-'Amiri, who was one of the most famous and bravest horsemen of the Jahiliyyah, came with some other horsemen, and crossed the ditch to the Muslim side. The Messenger of Allah jg called for the Muslim cavalry, and it was said that no one came forward.

648 Tafslr Ibn KathXr Then he called 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, who came forward and they fought in single combat until Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, killed him, and this was a sign of imminent victory. Then Allah sent an intensely cold wind with strong gusts against the Confederates, and they were left with no tents or anything else; they could not light any fires or do anything, and so they departed, disappointed and defeated, as Allah says: ^&p fi'Z \ \$p#8 ip: sji 40 you who believe! Remember Allah's favor to you, when there came against you hosts, and We sent against them a wind

and forces^ Mujahid said: "This was the easterly wind." This view is supported by another Hadith: jIp *(> 1 t-k!L o>V-aji> 0/ was given victory by the easterly wind, and 'Ad were destroyed by the westerly wind.'i* 11 4and forces that you saw not.) This refers to the angels who shook them and cast fear and terror into their hearts. The chief of each tribe said, "O Banu so-and-so, to me!" So they gathered around him, and he said, "Let us save ourselves," when Allah cast fear and terror into their hearts. In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Ibrahim At-Taymi said that his father said: "We were with Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman, may Allah be pleased with him, and a man said to him: If I had met the Messenger of Allah ^ I would have fought alongside him and I would have striven my utmost.' Hudhayfah said to him: *Would you really have done that? I was present with the Messenger of Allah during (the campaign) against the Confederates on a very cold and windy night, and the Messenger of Allah sg£ said: HyUiJl ^ pill Ji-j iiT Path Al-B&ri 2 :604

«Js there any man who will bring me news of the people? He will be with me on the Day of Resurrection .» None of us answered him, and he repeated it a second and a third time. Then he said: «0 Hudhayfah, get up and bring us news of the people.» When he called me by name, I had no choice but to get up. He said, j fry *Bring us news of the people, but do not alarm them .» So I went, walking as if I were walking among pigeons, until I came to them. I saw Abu Sufyan warming his back by the fire, and I put an arrow in my bow, wanting to shoot it at him, then I remembered what the Messenger of Allah \$g said, aDo not alarm them .« If I shot the arrow, I would have hit him. So I came back, again walking as if I were walking among pigeons, and I came to the Messenger of Allah jgg. After my returning I began to feel very cold. I told the Messenger of Allah^ and he gave me to wear a spare cloak of his which he used to pray in. I slept until morning came, and when morning came, the Messenger of Allah fg said, *jUjIU pi «Get up, O sleepy oneh" 1] o; fJ&r iWhen they came upon you from above you> refers to the Confederates, 4and from below you.) We have already noted the report from Abu Hudhayfah that these were Banu Qurayzah. 1,1 Muslim 3:1414.

i's&S 4-JSK ££ u>/ien f/ie eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats,} means, from intense fear and terror. & 'oM> iand you were harboring doubts about Allah.} Ibn Jarir said: "Some of those who were with the Messenger of Allah jg, had doubts and thought that the outcome would be against the believers, and that Allah would allow that to happen." Muhammad bin Ishaq said concerning the Ayah & ojiSj 4,JSif 2\$\$^%} iwhen the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} "The believers had all kinds of doubts, and hypocrisy emerged to such an extent that Mu'attib bin Qushayr, the brother of Banu 'Amr bin 'Awf said: 'Muhammad was promising us that we would win the treasure of Chosroes and Caesar, but one of us cannot even go and relieve himself. Al-Hasan said concerning the Ayah iand you were harboring doubts about Allah.} "There were different kinds of thoughts; the hypocrites thought that Muhammad jg and his Companions would be eliminated, while the believers were certain that what Allah and His Messenger jg promised was true, and that He would cause the religion to prevail even if the idolators hated it.",2, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Said, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "On the day of Al-Khandaq, we said: 'O Messenger of Allah, is there anything we should say, for our hearts have reached our throats?' He said: 111 Ibn Hisham 1:522. Al-Tabari 20:221.

«Yes, say: O Allah, cover our weak points and calm our fears. Then [Allah] struck the faces of the enemy with the wind, and defeated them with the wind. This was also recorded by Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal from Abu ‘Amir Al-‘Aqadi. [11 ill. There, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking.] ill. And when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease said: “Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!”} il3. And when a party of them said: “O people of Yathrib! There is no position for you. Therefore go back!” And a band of them ask for permission of the Prophet saying : “Truly, our homes lie open.” And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.}

How the Believers were tested, and the Position of the

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4515–4544]

Hypocrites during the Battle of Al-Khandaq Allah tells us what happened when the Confederates surrounded Al-Madinah and the Muslims were besieged and found themselves in straitened circumstances, with the Messenger of Allah in their midst. They were tried and tested, and were shaken with a mighty shaking. At this time hypocrisy emerged, and those in whose hearts was a disease spoke about what they really felt. / li « •! • ti ..y Af , 'of&i& &} iAnd when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease said: "Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!"} Their hypocrisy became apparent, while the one in whose heart was doubt became weak, and he expressed the ideas that were in his heart because of the weakness of his faith 111 Ahmad 3 :3

and the difficulty of the situation. And other people said, as Allah tells us: iAnd when a party of them said: "O people of Yathrib meaning Al-Madlnah, as it was reported in the §ahih: ty i«Sf>3 Sfk&b 31s ffiJi J cj« •4 «/ was shown in a dream the place to which you will migrate, a land between two lava fields. At first I thought it was Hajar, but it turned out to be YathribJ111 According to another narration: «Al-Madinah .» It was said that the origin of its name Yathrib was that a man settled there from (the people of) Al-‘Amallq whose name was Yathrib bin TJbayd bin Mahlayil bin ‘Aws bin ‘Amlaq bin Lawudh bin Iram bin Sam bin NQh. This was the view of As-Suhayli. He said: “And it was narrated from some of them that he said, It is given eleven names in the Tawrah: Al- Madinah, Tabah, Tayyibah, Al-Misklnah, Al-Jabirah, Al-Muhib- bah, Al-Mahbdbah, Al-Qasimah, Al-MajbOrah, Al-‘Adhra’ and Al-MarhQmah. iThere is no position for you .)> means, here, with the Prophet jg, you cannot stand guard,’ ^Therefore go back‘d means, ‘to your houses and dwellings’. 4And a band of them ask for permission of the Prophet} Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said, “These were Banu Harithah, who said, We fear for our homes, that they may be robbed.”,2, This was also stated 111 PathAl-Bari 12:439. At-Tabari 20:226.

653 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (14 -17) (Part-21) by others. Ibn Ishaq mentioned that the one who said this was ‘Aws bin Qayzi. 111 They were using as an excuse to go back to their houses the claim that they were lying open and had nothing to protect them from the enemy, so they were afraid for their homes. But Allah said: iAnd they lay not open meaning, it is not as they claim. iThey but wished to flee.\$ means, they wanted to run away from the battlefield. ip iu\$ •AiJj b> 1*5*5 jii UjLLi! oU-J ^ 3 j i' oig &Vf 5 JJ Oi i 'if 'i o* J» 5 <p^' i >^*« -*j-i> uj Xi 6; if^ 4 Wf. 5j b: jc Is? i <£. ft# 3i -if os 4©IW 424. And if the enemy had entered from all sides, and they had been exhorted to Al-Fitnah, they would surely

have committed it and would have hesitated thereupon but little> 425. And indeed they had already made a covenant with Allah in At-Jabari 20 :225

not to him their backs, and a covenant with Allah must be answered for.} 416. Say: "Flight will not avail you if you flee from death or killing and then you will enjoy no more than a little while!"} il7. Say: "Who is he who can protect you from Allah if He intends to harm you, or intends mercy on you?" And they will not find, besides Allah, for themselves any protector or any helper.} Allah tells us about those who said: ' > > 1 "Who is he who can protect you from Allah if He intends to harm you, or intends mercy on you?" And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.} If the enemy had entered upon them from every side of Al-Madīnah and from every direction, then demanded that they become disbelievers, they would have promptly done so. They would not have adhered to their faith or remained steadfast in it if they were faced with the slightest fear. This is how it was interpreted by Qatadah, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd and Ibn Jarir. ' This is a condemnation of them in the clearest terms. Then Allah reminds them of the promise they had made to Him before this fear struck them, that they would not turn their backs or flee from the battlefield. i' '<&} i and a covenant with Allah must be answered for.} means, Allah will inevitably ask them about that covenant. Then Allah tells them that fleeing from battle will not delay their appointed demise or make their lives any longer; on the contrary, it may be the cause of their being taken sooner, and in a sudden manner. Allah says: i and then you will enjoy no more than a little while!} meaning, 'after you run away and flee from battle.' in At-Tabari 20 :227

655 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (18 - 19) (Part-21) i Say: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is better for him who has Taqwa" (4:77). Then Allah says: O A , fi V > ^ \$ iyt* .>1)1 dj «i' ^ cfjff 'i dr 4 Say : "Who is he who can protect you from Allah if He intends to harm you, or intends mercy on you?" And they will not find, besides Allah, for themselves any protector or any helper.} meaning, they have no one else except Allah to respond to their cries. VJ (j-tjT OjStj *Jj pi ^1; ill iu> oi^> Ijji 41S. Allah already knows those among you who keep back (men) from fighting (in Allah's cause), and those who say to their brethren, "Come here towards us," while they come not to the battle except a little,} 419. Being miserly towards you. Then when fear comes, you will see them looking to you, their eyes revolving like one over whom hovers death; but when the fear departs, they will smite you with sharp tongues, miserly towards good. Such have not believed. Therefore, Allah makes their deeds fruitless and that is ever easy for Allah.} Allah tells us that His knowledge encompasses those who sought to tell others not to go out and who said to their brethren, meaning their companions, friend and acquaintances, ih 4 Come here towards us,} meaning, come to where we are in the shade and enjoying fruits. But in spite of that. 1 Ji VI 3\$ '4\ %}

J zZjj>E j JJ ijJi 4>&' '-*--4 p vi^i is (^j iy^=* jL> 0 420. They think that the Confederates have not yet withdrawn; and if the Confederates should come , they would wish they were in the deserts among the bedouins, seeking news about you; and if they were to be among you, they would not fight but little.) This is another aspect of their abhorrent attribute of cowardice and fear: iifr. p&& Sfi^z) i They think that the Confederates have not yet withdrawn; and that they are still close by and will return. o* j j} 1fkn vb-3-"^^ df}) 4 and if the Confederates should come, they would wish they were in the deserts among the bedouins, seeking news about you;) means, "if the Confederates should come back, they hope that they will not be present with you in Al-Madīnah, but that they will be in the desert, asking

about news of you and what happened to you with your enemy.' iU^ u p iand if they were to be among you, they would not fight but little.) means, If they are among you, they will not fight alongside you very much,' because they are so cowardly and weak, and have so little faith, but Allah knows best about them. % 'M pJ5 af tJS&A te.&\ U& 4P& % & Sii £ ui tjtf Cj CS 421 . Indeed in the Messenger of Allah you have a good example to follow for him who hopes in Allah and the Last Day, and remembers Allah much.)

« si? 32 £1: ts; iplfj itsfaj ,£1: JjSj ^ 'jljjj o', ^ <*' £#-• '.£*' f it ^Or f/ti/ifu you that you will enter Paradise with- out such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said,"When (will come) the help of Allah?" Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!){2:214} meaning, "this is the trial and test that Allah and His Messenger promised us would be followed by the help and victory of Allah that is near.' Allah asmstarns tT ' o\$4ii\Xzi CAjSXj-^>(>Jd IJ>1_J^ y > ~y_ ' ^ >> ' Jcy^ob\$ says: 4«n<f Allah and His Messenger had spoken the truth.) «tU2J &j yi Ji# <\$And if only added to theirfaith and to their submissiveness.) This indicates that faith can increase and strengthen in accordance with people's circumstances, as the majority of scholars stated: faith can increase and decrease. We have stated this at the beginning of our commentary on Al-Bukhari, m Af-Tabari 20 :236

660 TafsTr Ibn Kathir praise be to Allah. iAnd it only added> means, at that time of stress and difficulty i&L\t ty} <to theirfaith} in Allah, iand to their submissiveness.} means their submission to His commands and their obedience to His Messenger j"1 ' . O* |*rV t>* •>* (*-» i--)® U J*rj i5j?P' OiT p- * -k I ill ujixiii iil ijljb <C|i^\$&& of* U <23. Among the believers are men who have been true to their covenant with Allah ; of them some have fulfilled their Nahbah; and some ofthem are still waiting, but they have never chimged in the least.} <24. That Allah may reward the men of truth far their truth, and punish the hypocrites, if He wills, or accept their repentance by turning to them. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Praise for the Believers* Attitude, and leaving the ultimate Fate ofthe Hypocrites to Allah When Allah mentions how the hypocrites broke their promise to Him that they would not turn their backs. He describes the believers as firmly adhering to theircovenant and their promise: i[they] have been true to their covenant with Allah; of them some havefulfilled their Nahbah;} Some of them said: "Met their appointed time (i.e., death)." Al- Bukhari said, "Their covenant, and refers back to the beginning of the At/ah." FathAl-B6ri 8:377.

0* (*r^ 4ond some of them are still waiting, but they have never changed in the least.} means, they have never changed or broken their covenant with Allah. Al-Bukhari recorded that Zayd bin Thabit said: "When we wrote down the Mushaf, an Ayah from Surat Al-Ahzab was missing, which I used to hear the Messenger of Allah reciting. I did not find it with anyone except Khuzaymah bin Thabit Al-Ansari, may Allah be pleased with him, whose testimony the Messenger of Allah jg counted as equal to that of two other men. (The Ayah in question was:) 4»' \)X& iAmong the believers are men who have been true to their covenant with Allah This was recorded by Al-Bukhari but not by Muslim, It was also recorded by Ahmad in his Musnad, and by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal in the chapters on Tafsir in their Sunans. At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih."*2' Al-Bukhari also recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "We think that this Ayah was revealed concerning Anas bin An-Nadr, may Allah be pleased with him: itJ& 2lf tjJLji C 1.3,.. • O&pl Irty iAmong the believers are men who have

been true to their covenant with Allah . £”*31 This was reported only by Al-Bukhari, but there are corroborating reports with other chains of narration. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said: “My paternal uncle Anas bin Al-Nadr, may Allah be pleased with him, after whom I was named, was not present with this Messenger of Allah at Badr, and this distressed him. He said: The first battle at l| Fath Al-B&ri 8 :377 Ahmad 5:188, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:520, An-Nasdl in Al-Kubrd 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 377

663Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (23 - 24) (Part-21 “Their covenant, iand some of them are still waiting} they are waiting for battle so that they can do well.” ’ Al-Hasan said: iof them some have fulfilled their Nahbah;} “They died true to their covenant and loyal, and some are still waiting to die in a similar manner, and some ofthem have never changed in the least.”121 This was also the view of Qatadah and Ibn Zayd. Some ofthem said that the word Nahbah means a vow. ^but they have never changed in the least.} means, they never changed their covenant or were disloyal or committed treachery, but they persisted in what they had promised and did not break their vow, unlike the hypocrites who said: //-’ *, / j > . / ./ ^> / //>» i, V l&i Jt Truly , our homes lie open.” And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.} [33:13] c& v iAnd indeed they had already made a covenant with Allah not to turn their backs,} [33:15] iThat Allah may reward the men of truth for their truth, and punish the hypocrites, ifHe wills, or accept their repentance by turning to them.} Allah tests His servants with fear and shaking so as to tell the evil from the good, as each will be known by his deeds. Although Allah knows what the outcome will be before anything happens, still He does not punish anyone on the 111 At-Tabari 20:238. 121 At-Tabari 20:239.

they gained no advantage. Allah sufficedfor the believers in the fighting. And Allah is Ever All-Strong, All-Mighty.} Allah drovebacktheConfederatesdisappointedand lost Allah tells us how he drove the Confederates away from Al- Madlnah by sending against them a wind and troops of angels. If Allah had not made his Messenger a Mercy to the Worlds, this wind would have been more severe than the barren wind which He sent against ‘Ad, but Allah says: iAnd Allah would not punish them while you are amongst them (8 :33). So, Allah sent them a wind which dispersed them after they had gathered on the basis of their whims. They were a mixture of tribes and parties with a variety of opinions, so it was befitting that a wind should be sent against them that would scatter them and break up their gathering, driving them back disappointed and lost in their hatred and enmity. They did not achieve any worldly good such as the victory and booty that they had hoped for, nor did they achieve any good in the Hereafter, because of their sin of declaring enmity against the Messenger jg and seeking to kill him and destroy his army. Whoever wants and seriously intends to do a thing is the same as one who actually does it. 4J ojrtjii’ iii iAllah sufficedfor the believers in thefighting.} means, they did not have to fight them in order to expel them from their land, but Allah Alone sufficed them and helped His servant and granted victory to His troops. Hence the Messenger of Allah jg used to say, » ‘• > ~ - - C- > " • - , f ^XS’ J-Ulij toJi*j vi y’i v’» ‘None has the right to be worshipped but Allah, Alone, He was true to His promise, and He helped His servant, and He gave might to His soldiers and defeated the Confederates alone and there is nothing after Him.

426. And those of the People of the Scripture who backed them, Allah brought them down from their forts and cast terror into their hearts; a group you killed, and a group you made captives. 427. And He

caused you to inherit their lands, and their houses, and their riches, and a land which you had not trodden. And Allah is able to do all things. The Campaign against Banu Qurayzah We have already noted that when the Confederates came and camped outside Al-Madlnah, Banu Qurayzah broke the covenant that existed between them and the Messenger of Allah jg. This happened by the agency of Huyay bin Akhtab An-Nadari, may Allah curse him, who entered their stronghold and would not leave their leader, KaTi bin Asad, alone until he agreed to break the covenant. Among the things that he said to him was, "Woe to you! This is the opportunity for glory. The Quraysh and their company of men from various tribes, and the Ghatafan and their followers, have come to you, and they will stay here until they eliminate Muhammad and his companions." Kah said to him, "No, by Allah, this is the opportunity for humiliation. Woe to you, O Huyay, you are a bad omen. Leave us alone." But Huyay kept trying to persuade him until he agreed to his request. He laid down the condition that if the Confederates went away without doing anything, he [Huyay] would join them in their stronghold and would share their fate. When Banu Qurayzah broke their covenant and news of this reached the Messenger of Allah jg, he and the Muslims were veiy distressed by that. When Allah helped him by suppressing his enemy and driving them back disappointed and lost, having gained nothing, the Messenger of Allah 3g returned to Al-Madlnah in triumph and the people put down their weapons. While the Messenger of Allah sg was washing off the dust of battle in the house of Umm Salamah, may Allah be pleased with her, Jibril, upon him be peace, came to him wearing a turban of brocade, riding on a mule on which was a cloth of silk brocade. He said, "Have you put down your weapons, O Messenger of Allah?"

arm vein during the campaign of Al-Khandaq. The Messenger of Allah jgg had had his vein cauterized and had brought him to stay in a tent in the Masjid so that he could keep a close eye on him. One of the things that Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, said in his supplication was, "O Allah, if there is still anything that has to do with the war against Quraysh, then keep me alive for it, and if You decree that the war between us and them is over, then let the bleeding be renewed, but do not let me die until I get my satisfaction with regard to Banu Qurayzah." Allah answered his prayer and decreed that they would agree to be referred to him for judgement, and this was their own free choice. When this happened, the Messenger of Allah jg called him to come from Al-Madlnah to pass judgement on them. When he arrived, riding on a donkey that had been specially equipped for him to ride, some of the 'Aws began to urge him not to be too harsh, saying, "O Sa'd, they are your clients so be kind to them, trying to soften his heart." But he kept quiet and did not answer them. When they persisted in their request, he said, "Now it is time for Sa'd to make sure that no rebuke or censure will divert him from the path of Allah." Then they knew that he would not let them live. When he reached the tent where the Messenger of Allah was, the Messenger of Allah jg said: >Stand upfor your leader . » So the Muslims stood up for him, and welcomed him with honor and respect as befitted his status and so that his judgement would have more impact. When he sat down, the Messenger ofAllah said: 'These people» - and he pointed to them - 'have agreed to accept your judgement, so pass judgement on them as you wish .» Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "My judgement will be carried out?" The Messenger of Allfih jg said: "Yes." He said, "And it will be carried out on those who are in this tent?" He said, "Yes." He said, "And on those who are on this side?" - and he pointed towards the side where the Messenger

when there came to them that which they had recognized, they disbelieved in it} (2 :89). May the curse of Allah be upon them. ifrom their forts> means, from their strongholds. This was the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, 'Ata', Qatadah, As-SuddI and others of the Salaf. > .. 4 <-*-*>? 4and cast terror into their hearts;} means fear, because they had supported the idolators in their war against the Messenger of Allah jfe and the one who knows is not like the one who does not know. They had terrified the Muslims and intended to kill them so as to gain earthly power, but their plans backfired; the idolators ran away and the believers were victorious while the disbelievers were losers; where they had aimed for glory, they were humiliated. They wanted to eradicate the Muslims but they were themselves eradicated. In addition to all this, they are doomed in the Hereafter, so by all accounts they are counted as losers. Allah says: \$a group you killed, and a group you made captives.} Those who were killed were their warriors, and the prisoners were their children and women. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Atiyah Al-Qurazi said, "I was shown to the Prophet on the day of Qurayzah, because they were not sure about me. The Prophet sg told them to look at me to see whether I had grown any body hair yet. They looked and saw that I had not grown any body hair, so they let me go and I was put with the other prisoners."*2 * This was also recorded by the Sunan compilers, and At-Tirmidhi said it is Hasan Sahih."*3 * An-Nasal also recorded something similar ,l] At-Tabari 20 :249 121 Ahmad 4 :383 * Abu Dawud 4:561, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:207, An-Nasal in Al- Kubrd 5 :185 , Ibn Majah 2 :849

rV^• «./ / »/ > /*" J •>»/• . hFV> ^ ^11 i *L«a1> (C^L?LAljJZs)Cj^j 0\jiU l<jj[^LJk! ZJ \jCi==j^v-
jiiifiy _ • -t- . » . <•>!^ ^ --V Tf' r t'' f^TM| Ia^U^j j4-*£==J-fj4itolX \$ o>%='!jv5 gggpgtt^ 'Ikrimah
said: "At that time he was married to nine women, five of them were from Quraysh - 'A'ishah, Hafsa.
Umm Hablbah, Sawdah and Umm Salamah, may Allah be pleased with them. And he was also married

to Safiyyah bint Huyay An- Nadariyyah, Maymunah bint Al- Harith Al-Hilaliyyah, Zaynab bint Jahsh Al- Asadiyyah and Juwayriyyah bint Al- Harith Al- Mustalaqiyyah, may Allah be pleased with all of them. 0^i 'r^i Cy ir*' *1—iri^ ./ ^ . >" 5 U^v» J—oj 4U *-A tj+j cAj«a^ c-jUuJ1 i?ir* ^-A)1 430. O wives of the Prophet! Whoever of you commits an open Fahishah, the torment for her will be doubled, and that is ever easy for Allah.} <31. And whosoever of you is obedient to Allah and His Messenger, and does righteous good deeds, We shall give her, her reward twice over, and We have prepared for her a noble provision .} At-Tabari 20 :252

The Wives of the Prophet^ are not like Other Women This Ayah is addressed to the wives of the Prophet who chose Allah and His Messenger and the Home of the Hereafter, and remained married to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Thus it was befitting that there should be rulings which applied only to them, and not to other women, in the event that any of them should commit open Fahishah. Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “This means Nushuz (rebellion) and a bad attitude.”¹¹¹ Whatever the case, this is a conditional phrase and it does not imply that what is referred to would actually happen. This is like the Ayat jEXj cxi ij* cd '&>} 4And indeed it has been revealed to you, as it was to those before you : "If you join others in worship with Allah, surely your deeds will be in vain."} (39:65) 4oflZ ijgil &} 4But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that they used to do would have been of no benefit to them.} (6:88) bti jjJ oj 4Say : "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of (Allah's) worshippers."} (43:81) % J & SS? ji> 4Had Allah willed to take a son, He could have chosen whom He willed out of those whom He created. But glory be to Him! He is Allah, the One, the Irresistible.} (39:4). Because their status is so high, it is appropriate to state that the sin, if they were to commit it, would be so much worse, so as to protect them and their Hijab. Allah says: vtiSit cy} 4Whoever of you commits an open Fahishah, the torment for

the torment for her will be doubled, “In this world and the next.” Something similar was narrated from Ibn Abi Najih, from Mujahid. and that is ever easy for Allah. it is very easy indeed. Then Allah mentions His justice and His bounty, in the Ayah a h csjfr \$And whosoever of you is obedient to Allah and His Messenger,} i.e., obeys Allah and His Messenger jg, %a!££& GJS iWe shall give her, her reward twice over, and We have prepared for her a noble provision .} i.e., in Paradise, for they will be in the dwellings of the Messenger of Allah jg in the highest reaches of ‘Mpm, 1 ’ above the dwellings of all the people, in Al-WasUah¹²¹ which is the closest of the dwellings of Paradise to the Throne. •*J5 <j tfjll — yi il' Of ,jv_ - S*il> &V' (iv 'Jz 4 Xj» o£> c^r cr^t iit vd *^=*ib\$ oii'» Of 4 4^ . ^ olJi jil 4#*^^ 'i' 0> <32. O wives of the Prophet! You are not like any other women. If you keep you have Taqwd, then be not soft in speech, lest he in whose heart is a disease should be moved with desire, but speak in an honorable manner.} [1 ' See the explanation of S&rat Al- Muttaffilfin 83 :18. ' See the heading “Occasions for saying Salah upon him” under the explanation of Ayah no. 56. of this Surah.

6.78 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 433. And stay in your houses, and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance, and perform the Salah, and give Zakah and obey Allah and His Messenger. Allah wishes only to remove the Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification> 434. And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah. Verily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things. Enjoining certain Manners so that the Mothers of the Believers may be an Example; and the Prohibition of

Tabarruj These are the good manners which Allah enjoined upon the wives of the Prophet ﷺ so that they would be an example for the women of the Ummah to follow. Allah said, addressing the wives of the Prophet ﷺ that they should fear Allah as He commanded them, and that no other woman is like them or can be their equal in virtue and status. Then Allah says: *ithen be not soft in speech As-Suddi* and others said, this means, do not be gentle in speech when addressing men. Allah says: *ilest he in whose heart is a disease should be moved with desire means, something unclean.* 46£1 *£» Jijfr 4but speak in an honorable manner.> Ibn Zayd said: “Decent and honorable talk that is known to be good.”¹¹ ! This means that she should address non-Mahram men in a manner in which there is no softness, i.e., a woman should not address a non- Mahram man in the sameway that she addresses her husband. At-Tabari 20:258.

4And stay in your houses, means, stay in your houses and do not come out except for a purpose. One of the purposes mentioned in Shari'ah is prayer in the Masjid, so long as the conditions are fulfilled, as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *J J&l * jiil »li} IjjwJ V •Do not prevent the female servants of Allah from the Masjids of Allah, but have titem go out without wearing fragrance. »J* According to another report: *'leven though their houses are betterfor them .» & p^ vj 4and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance,*4 Mujahid said: “Women used to go out walking in front of men, and this was the Tabarruj of Jahiliyyah.”³¹ Qatadah said: */ ^ £ »* s y t* .*<" <^ iand do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabumij of the times ofignorance,*4 “When they go out of their homes walking in a shameless and flirtatious manner, and Allah, may He be exalted, forbade that.”⁴¹ Muqatil bin Hayyan said: *4and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance,*4 “Tabarruj is when a woman puts a Khimar on her head but does not tie it properly.”⁵ *** Abu Dfiwud 1 :381 > Abu Dawud 1 :382. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :602 > At-Tabari 20:259. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :602

So her necklaces, earrings and neck, and all of that can be seen. This is Tabarruj, and Allah addresses all the women of the believers with regard to Tabarruj. *iand perform the Salah, and give Zakdh and obey Allah and His Messenger.}* Allah first forbids them from evil, then He enjoins them to do good by establishing regular prayer, which means worshipping Allah alone with no partner or associate, and paying Zakah, which means doing good to other people. *iand obey Allah and His Messenger.}* This is an instance of something specific being followed by something general. The Wives of the Prophet ﷺ are Members of His Household (Ahl Al-Bayt) *iAllah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of thefamily, and to purify you with a thorough purification.}* This is a clear statement that the wives of the Prophet are included among the members of his family (Ahl Al-Bayt) here, because they are the reason why this Ayah was revealed, and the scholars are unanimously agreed that they were the

reason for revelation or there was also another reason, which

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4544–4549]

is the correct view. Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Ikrimah used to call out in the marketplace: *iAllah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijsfrom you, O members of thefamily, and to purify you with a thorough purification.}* “This was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet.”¹¹ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning the Ayah: *m At-Tabari 20 :267*

4^” ^ =st^ C^* Sif 4i>. 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family,} “It was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet jg.” Ikrimah said: “Whoever disagrees with me that it was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet jg, I am prepared to meet with him and pray and invoke the curse of Allah upon those who are lying.” * So they alone were the reason for revelation, but others may be included by way of generalization. Ibn Jarir narrated that Safiyyah bint Shaybah said: “A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, The Prophet went out one morning wearing a striped cloak of black camel’s hair. Al- Hasan, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with him. Then Al-Husayn, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with him. Then Fatimah, may Allah be pleased with her, came and he wrapped her in the cloak with him. Then ‘Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with him, then he jgg said: 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} This was recorded by Muslim.*2 In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Yazid bin Hayyan said: “Husayn bin Sabrah, TJmar bin Muslim and I went to Zayd bin Arqam, may Allah be pleased with him, and when we had sat down with him, Husayn said: *You are so fortunate, O Zayd! You saw the Messenger of Alldh jg and heard his speeches, and you went on military campaigns with him, and you prayed behind him. You are so fortunate, O Zayd! Tell us what you heard from the Messenger of Allah He said, ‘O son of my brother, by Allah, I have grown old and it has been a long time, and I have forgotten some of the things that I *** Recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn ‘As&kir. Ad-Durr Al-Manthur * Af-Tabari 20 :261 , Muslim no. 2081

683 Surah 33 . Al-Ahzab (32 - 34) (Part-22 doubt that the wives of the Prophet are included among those who are referred to in the Ayah: 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} The context clearly refers to them. Allah then says: k 4& u 4And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Aydt of Allah and Al-Hikmah.} meaning, ‘act in accordance with that of the Qur’an and Sunnah which Allah revealed to His Messenger jg in your houses.’ This was the view of Qatadah and others. ‘And remember this blessing with which you alone of all the people have been favored, that the revelation comes down in your houses and not those of other people.’ ‘A’ishah As-Siddiqah bint As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with them, was foremost among them with in this blessing and was the most fortunate, and the most favored with this mercy. For the revelation did not come to the Messenger of Allah in the bed of any of his wives except hers, as he stated. Some of the scholars, may Allah have mercy on them, said: “This was because he did not many any other virgin besides her, and no man slept with her in her bed before him | J], may Allah be pleased with her.” So it was befitting that she should be singled out for this blessing and high status. But if his wives are members of his household, then this title is even more fitting for his own relatives. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Jamllah said: “Al-Hasan bin ‘Ali, may Allah be pleased with them both, was appointed as Khalifah when ‘Ali was killed.” He said: “While he was praying, a man leapt on*him and stabbed him with a dagger.” Husayn claimed that he heard that the one who stabbed him was a man from Banu Asad, and Al-Hasan, may Allah be pleased with him, was prostrating at the time. He said, “They claimed that he received the wound in his hip. He was ill as a [i] At-Tabari 20:268.

result for many months, then he recovered. He ascended the Minbar and said: *0 people of Iraq! Have Taqwa of Allah concerning us, for we are your leaders and your guests, and we are members of the

family (AW Al-Bayf) concerning whom Allah said: v-jx}. %j>, £3^ 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.}' He kept saying this until there was no one left in the Masjid who was not weeping and sobbing." 'it \} ^Verily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} means, "by His kindness towards you, you have reached this status, and by His knowledge of you and that you are qualified for that status, He has given this to you and singled you out for it.' Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him, said: "And remember how Allah blessed you by causing the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah to be recited in your houses, so give thanks to Allah for that and praise Him. -it \} iVerily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} means, *He is kind towards you, for He has caused the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah to be recited in your houses,' and Al-Hikmah means the Sunnah. And He is Well-Acquainted with you means, *He chose you as wives for His Messenger.' 11 ' Qatadah said: Of 4 4^1 l* Cij^iij} 4And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah.} "He is reminding them of His favor." This was narrated by Ibn Jarir.,2 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi commented on the Ayah: At-Tabari 20:268. 121 At-Tabari 20:268.

\$\^S & \} iVerily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} "He knows when and where to reveal Al-Hikmah." This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hfitim, then he said: "This was also narrated from Ar-Rabl' bin Anas from Qat&dah." cjjJ'.Jl i*.^ 1 ,iY jj £Jj££ £oT ai^5 cM:j \$35. Verily, the Muslims: men and women, the believers: men and women, the QSnit: men and the women, the men and women who are truthful, the men and the women who are patient, the Khashi' : men and the women, the men and the women who give Sadaqdt, the men and the women who fast, the men and the women who guard their chastity and the men and the women who remember Allah much with their hearts and tongues, Allah has prepared for them forgiveness and a great reward.}

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4549–4556]

Imam Ahmad recorded that Umm Salamah, may Allah be pleased with her, the wife of the Prophet said, "I said to the Prophet \$jj\$, Why is it that we are not mentioned in the Qur'an as men are?' Then one day without my realizing it, he was calling from the Minbar and I was combing my hair, so I tied my hair back then I went out to my chamber in my house, and I started listening out, and he was saying from the Minbar. •\$c4g& \} :Jfo. JU; 2.1 b\ ,>&! "O people! Verily Allah.says: \$Verily, the Muslims: men and women, the believers: men and women...} to the end of the Ayah.' This was also recorded by An- Nasal and Ibn Jarir.12' 111 Ahmad 6:305. An-Nasfil in Al-Kubrd 6 :431 , Af-Tabari 20 :270

iPpb l{ } iVerily, the Muslims: men and women, the believers: men and women... indicates that Iman is something other than Islam, and that it is more specific, because Allah says: 4 && Eti&& \pg \$ ji h: 4The bedouins say: "We believe." Say: "You believe not but you only say, 'We have surrendered (in Islam),' for faith has not yet entered your hearts."} (49:14). In the Two Sahlhs, it says: >J Ji'k 0~T Jti V "The adulterer does not commit adultery at the time when he is a believer .»(11 For it snatches away his Iman, although that does not mean he is a disbeliever, according to the consensus of the Muslims. This indicates that Iman is more specific than Islam, as we have stated at the beginning of our commentary on Al- Bukhari. 4the Qdnit: men and the women,} Al-Qunutmeans obedience during quite time. Tr-j

iyrfj ijf'H y>p} 4Is one who is (Qanit,) prostrating himself or standing in the middle of the night, fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy of his Lord...} (39:9) 4To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. All are Ucpmti (Qanitun) to Him.} (30:26) 111 Fath Al-Bdri 10:33, Muslim 1 : 77.

iO Maryam! "Uqnuti to your Lord and prostrate, and bow with Ar-RakVin (those who bow)."} (3:43) A boor iAnd stand before Allah QanitTn} (2:238). So, beyond Islam there is a higher level to be reached, which is /man, and Qunut stems from them both. iThe men and women who are truthful, This refers to their speech, for truthfulness is a praiseworthy attribute. Some of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, were never known to have lied even once, neither during JahUiyyah nor in Islam. Truthfulness is a sign of faith, just as lying is a sign of hypocrisy. Whoever is truthful will be saved: j^! p i&ii J! ^4* dp *J\ J! JjLUi jjd^» Jiji 'Jj 'jUi op (jj+j »_4sui j^pii Jij; ^ iixf <ii xp J>- jxUi ijxiji j>pji «C& 4>l xpC& C,&\ 4,iSS 'You have to be truthful, for truthfulness leads to righteousness and righteousness leads to Paradise. And beware of lying, for lying leads to immorality and immorality leads to Hell. A man will keep telling the truth and striving to do so until he will be recorded with Allah as a truthful. And a man will keep telling lies and will persist in doing so until he will be recorded with Allah as a /iar.»|11 And there are many Hadtths on this topic. iThe men and the women who are patient,} This is the attribute of those who are steadfast, which is patience in the face of adversity and knowing that what is decreed will inevitably come to pass. So, they face it with patience and steadfastness. Patience is the most difficult when disaster first strikes, then after that it becomes easier, and til Muslim 4:2013.

iThe men and the women who fast,} According to a Hadith narrated by Ibn M&jah: •jjJl i\Sj ^j^alvj «Fasting is the Zakah of the body . In other words, it purifies it and cleanses it of things that are bad in both physical and Shar'ī terms. Said bin Jubayr said: "Whoever fasts Ramadan and three days of each month, is included in the Ayah, iThe men and the women who fast,} '*2 Fasting is also one of the greatest means of overcoming one's desires, as the Messenger of Allah jg said: jJjLU 5»OI !v-<uljl j a} 31 «0 young men! Whoever among you can afford to get married, let him do so, for it is most effective in lowering the gaze and protecting the chastity. And whoever cannot get married, then let him fast, for it will be a protection for him.**3 It is quite apt that next should be mentioned: cji!LeX\j} iThe men and the women who guard their chastity} i.e., they protect their private parts from forbidden and sinful things, except for that which is permitted. Allah says: £ £&£\$& C i^0 &\ » ^ »4Si 0 iAnd those who guard their chastity. Except from their wives I 1 ' Ibn Majah 1 -.555. Something similar was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Ad-Dwrr Al- Manthur 5 :380 131 FathAl-B&ri9:14

«0 Allah, forgive those who shaved their hair. They said, 'And those who shortened.' *And those who shortened .« This was recorded by Imam Ahmad with this chain of narration.* 11 It was also recorded by Muslim, except for the last part of it. Oj Z0 & Zb iAllah has prepared for them forgiveness and a great reward. Here Allah tells us that for all of those mentioned in this Ayah, He has prepared for them forgiveness of their sins and a great reward, meaning, Paradise. J sums ^ mmm °-A=r'0 '<P0100^0 {p-hS#i. 20*Ji j*j if. 'tt J \A Mtf "j*" tif ij Z^./ { f'S i •/ JLOA All* 4 _j*3jO 436. It is not far a believer, man or woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decreed a matter that they should have any option

in their decision. And whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed strayed into a plain error. *** Ahmad 2:411 * Muslim 2:946.

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4556–4595]

Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Barzah Al-Aslami said: “Julayblb was a man who used to enter upon women and joke with them. I said to my wife, *Do not let Julayblb enter upon you, for if he enters upon you I shall do such and such.’ If any of the Ansar had a single female relative, they would not arrange a marriage for her until they found out whether the Prophet jgg wanted to marry her or not. The Prophet jg said to one of the Ansdr: *Give me your daughter for marriage . He said. Yes, O Messenger of Allah, it would be an honor and a blessing.’ He said, O/ do not want her for myself.» He said, Then for whom, O Messenger of Allah?’ He^ said. “For Julayblb .» He said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, let me consult her mother.’ So he went to the girl’s mother and said, The Messenger of Allah is proposing marriage for your daughter.’ She said, Yes, it would be a pleasure.’ He said, *He is not proposing to marry her himself, he is proposing on behalf of Julayblb.’ She said. What! Julayblb? No, by AMh, we will not marry her to him.’ When he wanted to get up and go to the Messenger of Allah jgg to tell him what the girl’s mother had said, the girl asked. Who is asking for my hand?’ So her mother told her, and she said, ‘Are you refusing to follow the command of the Messenger of Allah jg? Follow his command, for I will not come to any harm.’ So her father went to the Messenger of Allah jg and said, 1)681 with her as you wish.’ So he married her to Julayblb. Then the Messenger of Allah jg went out on one of his military campaigns, and after Allah had granted him victory, he said to his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, „ f Jf OjAia Ja

693 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (36) (Part-22 • See whether there is anybody missing .» They said, *We have lost so-and-so, and so-and-so.’ He jgg said, •J OjJiiij Ja • See if there is anybody missing .» They said, *No one.’ He jgg said: «iyU- isif • Buf J see that Julaybtb is missing .» He jgg said: •Go and look for him among the dead .» So they looked for him, and found him beside seven of the enemy whom he had killed before he was himself killed. They said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, here he is, beside seven of the enemy whom he had killed before he was himself killed.’ The Messenger of Allah jgg came and stood beside him and said, *0 bij iJLft iOjJulj • He killed seven before he was himself killed. He belongs to me and I belong to him. He said this two or three times, then the Messenger of Allah carried him in his arms and held him while his grave was dug, then he placed him in his grave. It was not mentioned that he washed him, may Allah be pleased with him.” Thabit, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “There was no widow among the Ansar who was more sought after for marriage than that girl.” Ishaq bin ‘Abdullah bin Abi Talhah asked Thabit, “Do you know how the Messenger of Allah prayed for that girl?” He told him: “He said, •ijs >ji LJp ^Li • O Allah, pour blessings upon her and do not make her Ufa hard. And this is how it was; there was no widow among the Ansar who was more sought after for marriage than her.” This is how it was recorded by Imam Ahmad, in full. 111 Ahmad 4:422.

Muslim and An-Nasab recorded the story of his death in Al-Fada’il 1 • Al-Hafiz Abu Umar bin ‘Abd Al-Barr mentioned in Al-Istisab that when the girl said in her seclusion, ‘Are you refusing to follow the command of the Messenger of Allah jg?’ - This Ayah was revealed: A im f «P. of it is not for a believer,

man or woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decreed a matter that they should have any option in their decision. It was narrated that Tawus asked Ibn ‘Abbas about praying two Rak’ahs after ‘Asr and he told him not to do that. Ibn ‘Abbas recited: $\wedge (*5^{\wedge} <y, Cji' ft J \backslash f \wedge a "jj jtt \backslash fj \}$ it is not for a believer, man or woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decreed a matter that they should have any option in their decision, }13] This Ayah is general in meaning and applies to all matters, i.e., if Allah and His Messenger jgj decreed a matter, no one has the right to go against that, and no one has any choice or room for personal opinion in this case. Allah says: • it-', i «<•! (-tr-'' t| ^ u_i <\$»- y Qjj iBut no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them, and find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept (them) with full submission.} (4:65) Hence the issue of going against it is addressed in such strong terms, as Allah says: 5fcb> J-» jii ffnf J*j} iAnd whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed strayed into a plain error.} *** Muslim no. 2482, An-NasI in Al-Kubra no. 8246. Al-IstCab 1 :259. ‘Abdur-Razzaq 2 :433

695 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (37) (Part-22) This is like the Ayah: (• jS iiSi of o6 4A«d lei those who oppose the Messenger's commandment, beware, lest some Fitnah should befall them or a painful torment be inflicted on them^ (24:63). •{/ /•*/ / * ,4 // .*• // //•< < fJtti£j 4iil ifiTlf- lie, <CL> 4ji^ |*jwi c5aU Jyu i£ 5;s a tez j £5 ift J5ar^ 4.4? & \5 fft 'jj tj {f?~ Jp ^ if >?* 437. And (remember) when you said to him on whom Allah has bestowed grace and you have done a favor : "Keep your wife to yourself, and have Taqwa of Allah." But you did hide in yourself that which Alliih will make manifest, you did fear the people whereas Allah had a better right that you should fear Him. So, when Zayd had completed his aim with her, We gave her to you in marriage, so that there may be no difficulty to the believers in respect of the wives of their adopted sons when the latter have no desire to keep them. And AllSh's command must be fulfilled> Allah's rebuke to His Messenger § and the Story of Zayd and Zaynab Allah tells what His Prophet said to his freed slave Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, who was the one on whom Allah had bestowed grace, i.e., through Islam and following the Messenger jj§. ii-S iand you have done a favor [to himft means, by freeing him from slaveiy. And he was a great leader, held in high esteem and beloved by the Prophet 3g&. He was known as the beloved, and his son Usamah was known as the beloved son of the beloved. ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: “The Messenger of Allah 2)g never sent him on a campaign but he appointed him as its commander, and if he had lived after him he would have appointed him as his Khalifah.” This was recorded by

be pleased with him, said: “When Zaynab's 'Iddah finished, may Allah be pleased with her, the Messenger of Allah ;g said to Zayd bin Harithah, “Go to her and tell her about me (that I want to marry her). So, he went to her and found her kneading dough. He (Zayd) said, When I saw her I felt such respect for her that I could not even look at her and tell her what the Messenger of Allah Sg had said, so I turned my back to her and stepped aside, and said, ‘O Zaynab! Rejoice, for the Messenger of Allah sg has sent me to propose marriage to you on his behalf.’ She said, I will not do anything until I pray to my Lord, may He be glorified.’ So she went to the place where she usually prayed. Then Qur’an was revealed and the Messenger of Allah sg came and entered without permission. We were there when she entered upon the Messenger of Allah Sg, and for the wedding feast we offered bread and meat. Then the people left, and some men stayed behind conversing in the house after they had eaten. The Messenger of Allah jg went out and I followed him. He Sg started to go around all the apartments of his wives, greeting them, and they said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, how did you find your (new) wife?’ I do not know

whether I or someone else told him that those people had left, so he went and entered the house, and I went to enter after him, but he drew the curtain between himself and I. The ruling of Hijab was revealed and he exhorted the people as Allah had exhorted them: *ip^ Ji% 1} iEnter not the Prophet's houses, unless permission is given to you}.*" This was also recorded by Muslim and An-Nasal. Al-Bukhari, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Zaynab bint Jahsh, may Allah be pleased with her, used to boast to the other wives of the Prophet *Sg*, saying, "Your families Ahmad 3 :195, Muslim no. 1428, An-Nasal 6 :79.

which specifically excludes adopted sons. This custom (of adopting sons) was widespread among them. *^ o&j) iAnd Allah's command must be fulfilled.)* means, *this that has happened was decreed by Allah and was inevitable.' Allah knew that Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her, would become one of the wives of the Prophet *jg. ol§ (Jt ij£- iL_l< /J ill' U_i ^»- ^ i38*. There is no blame on the Prophet in that which Allah has made legal for him. That has been Allah's way with those who have passed away of old. And the command of Allah is a decree determined. *4 it iii iThere is no blame on the Prophet in that which Allah has made legal for him.)* means, in that which has been permitted for him and which he has been commanded to do, i.e. his marrying Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her,, who had been divorced by his adopted son Zayd bin Harithah, *4 o*, +LL) iThat has been Allah's way with those who have passed away of old.)* means this is the ruling of Allah for the Prophets who came before him. Allah would not command them to do anything for which they might be blamed. This is a refutation of those hypocrites who imagined that there was anything wrong with his marrying the ex-wife of Zayd, his freed slave and adopted son. *iAnd the command of Allah is a decree determined.)* means, His command which He has decreed must inevitably come to pass; nothing can prevent it or avert it, for whatever He wills happens, and whatever He does not decree, does not happen.

i5 it,^ at -li £S if^ <^i & if og I411 ;&j if&&pQ ££ £2 of 439. Those to/who convey the Message of Allah and fear Him, and fear none save Allah. And sufficient is Allah as a Reckoner.) 440. Muhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.) Praise for Those Who convey the Message Allah says: *4if^ <Z\$) iThose who convey the Message of Allah)* meaning, to His creation, and fulfil that with which they have been entrusted. *45S25> 4and fear Him,)* means, they fear Him and they do not fear any besides Him, so no threats on the part of anyone can prevent them from conveying the Message of Allah. *4And sufficient is Allah as a Reckoner.)* means, sufficient is Allah as a Helper and Supporter. The leader of all people in this regard and in all regards is Muhammad the Messenger of Allah *jg*, for he undertook to convey the Message to the people of the east and of the west, to all kinds of the sons of Adam, so Allah caused his word, his religion and his law to prevail over all other religions and laws. The Prophets before him were sent only to their own peoples, but he *jg* was sent to all of mankind, Arabs and non-Arabs alike. *41 \$)* 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah") (7:158). Then his Ummah inherited the task of conveying from him.

and the greatest of those who undertook this task after him were his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, who conveyed from him as he had commanded them, describing all his words, deeds and circumstances, night and day, when he was settled and when he was traveling, in private and in public, may Allah be pleased with them. Thereafter each generation inherited from their predecessors until our

own time, so those who were guided, follow their example and their way. We ask Allah, the Most Generous Bestower, to make us among their heirs. The Messenger[^] is not the Father of any man Allah states: 4 Muhammad is not the father of any of your men,} After this it was not permitted to say Zayd bin Muhammad, i.e., he was not his father even though he had adopted him. No male child of the Prophet lived until puberty. Khadijah, may Allah be pleased with her, bore him Al-Qasim, At-Tayyib and Af-Tahir, but they died in childhood. Mariyah Al-Qibtiyyah bore him Ibrahim, but he also died in infancy. He ^{jjj} also had four daughters from Khadijah: Zaynab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthum and Fatimah, may Allah be pleased with them all. Three of them died during his lifetime, Fatimah lived long enough to be bereaved of him, then she died six months later. He is the Last of the Prophets & as L# & ^{jjj} but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.} This is like the Ayah: ik £3 >&} i Allah knows best with whom to place His Message} (6:124). This Ayah clearly states that there will be no Prophet after him. If there will be no Prophet after him then there will surely be no Messenger after him either, because the status of a Messenger is higher than that of a Prophet, for every

prophethood. »[11 This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Sahih Gharib .”I2> Another Hadith Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: <jl£i t£j V| IfrlSb Ijls J>-3 ^0 -C-Ij I Vl L« :<JU l^IJl «f*U0 JdVi^ «T7ie parable of myself and the Prophets is that of a man who built a house and did a complete and good job, except for the space of one brick. Whoever entered it would look at that space and say, how good it is, apart from the space of that brick. My position is like that of that brick, and the Prophets - blessings and peace be upon them - end with It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, Muslim and At-Tirmidhi, who said, “It is Sahih Gharib with this chain of narrators.”41 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah £gl said: «£JJI Sk “The parable of myself and the Prophets is that of a man who built a house and completed it apart from the space of one brick. ^ Ahmad 3:263. Similar was recorded by Al-Bukhari no. 6990, and the meaning is that the only remnant of prophethood that will exist after him is the truthful dream of the righteous Muslim, which was one of the many characteristics of prophethood. See Fath Al- Bari no . 6990 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :55 1 I3 ' Musnad At-Tayalisi 247 * Fath Al-Bari 6:645, Muslim 4:1791, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :158

earth has been made a Masjid and a means of purification for me; I have been sent to all of mankind; and the Prophets end with This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah; At- Tirmidhi said, “It is Hasan Sahlh,”*2 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said: »2Jl ili; Li *The parable of myself and the Prophets who came before me is that of a man who built a house and completed it apart from the space of one brick. I have come and completed that brick . »*3 It was also recorded by Muslim.14 Another Hadith Jubayr bin Mut'im, may Allah be pleased with him, said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jfe say: «iil jJl ^UJl ulj llj uf zILt'i jj> v?*-*** ij* 1^^-*' uf} <.fm\ "I have several names: I am Muhammad, and I am Ahmad; I am Al-Mdhi (the eradicator) through whom Allah will erase disbelief; I am Al-Hashir (the gatherer) at whose feet mankind will gather; and I am Al-'Aqib (the final one) after whom there will be no ProphetJ,5i It was also recorded in the Two Sahibs.*6 And there are many other

Hadiths on this topic. m Muslim 1:371. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :160 , Ibn Majah 1 :188 Ahmad 3 :9 * Muslim 4 :1791 Ahmad 4 :80 161 Fath Al-Bari8 :509 , Muslim 4 : 1828

Allah has told us in His Book, and His Messenger jgg has told us in the Mu.tawd.tir Sunnah, that there will be no Prophet after him, so that it may be known that everyone who claims this status after him is a liar and fabricator who is misguided and is misleading others. Even if he twists meanings, comes up with false claims and uses tricks and vagaries, all of this is false and is misguidance as will be clear to those who have understanding. This is what Allah caused to happen in the case of Al-Aswad Al-‘Ansi in the Yemen and Musaylimah the Liar in Al- Yamamah, whose false miracles and nonsensical words showed everyone who was possessed of understanding that they were liars who were leading people astray; may the curse of Allah be upon them both. This is the case with every false prophet until the Day of Resurrection, until they end with Al- MasVx Ad-Dajjal (the Antichrist). Each of these liars is given by Allah signs which show the people of knowledge and the believers that his message is false - which is part of the perfect kindness of Allah towards His creation. These liars do not enjoin what is good, nor forbid what is evil, unless they do so by coincidence or because it serves an ulterior purpose. They are the utmost in falsehood and immorality, in all that they say and do, as Allah says: mm m mmw^ i * *5 'i + c^==tL«L»j *-4*^

{Shall I inform you (0 people!) upon whom the Shayatin descend? They descend on every lying, sinful person (26 :221 -222) This is in contrast to the Prophets - may blessings and peace be upon them - for they are the utmost in righteousness, truthfulness, wisdom, uprightness and justice in all that they say and do, command and forbid. In addition to this they are supported with miracles and clear and obvious proof. May the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them always, as long as heaven and earth remain. £24 ' 2 Sfrow4& & !\$< £' m<4& ft s {41 . O you who believe! Remember Allah with much remembrance.} {42. And glorify His praises morning and Astla.} {43. He it is Who sends Saldh on you, and His angels too, that He may bring you outfrom darkness into light. And He is Ever Most Merciful to the believers.> {44. Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be "Saldm (Peace!)" And He has prepared for them a generous reward.} The Virtue ofrememberingAllahmuch Allah commands His believing servants to remember their Lord much. Who has bestowed upon them all kinds of blessings and favors, because this will bring them a great reward and a wonderful destiny. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Busr said: “Two bedouins came to the Messenger of Allah and one of them said: ‘O Messenger of Allah, which of the people is best?’ He jg said: ' l * Its explanation follows shortly.

and in health, in secret and openly, in all situations and circumstances. And Allah says: iArtd glorify His praises morning and Asila.} If you do this, He and His angels will send blessings upon you.” There are veiy many Ayat, Hadiths and reports which encourage the remembrance of Allah, and this Ayah, urges us to remember Him much. People such as An-Nasal and Al- Ma'mari and others have written books about the Adhkar to be recited at different times of the night and day. iAnd glorify His.praises morning and Astla in the morning and in the evening. This is like the Ayah . •tit' >i' ^ Ciw 4i\ > ,v , , iSo glorify Allah, wften you come up to the evening, and when you enter the morning. And His are all the praises and thanks in the heavens and the earth; and in the afternoon and when you come up to the time, when the day begins to decline. (30 :17-18). 43.4<& 4He it is Who sends Saldh on you, and His angels too,} This is encouragement to remember Allah, i.e., He will remember you, so remember Him. This is like

the Ayah: $\text{W} \wedge \text{Gijl}$ SET a '4 §P p £ 6 iSimilarly, We have sent among you a Messenger of your own, reciting to you Our Ayat and purifying you, and teaching you the Book and the Hikmah, and teaching you that which you used not to know. Therefore remember Me. I will remember [11 At-Tabari 20:280.

that He may bring you out from darkness into lights means, by means of His mercy towards you, His praise of you and the supplication of His angels for you, He brings you forth from the darkness of ignorance and misguidance into the light of guidance and certain faith. And He is Ever Most Merciful to the believers. means, in this world and in the Hereafter: in this world He guides them to the truth of which others are ignorant, and He shows them the path from which others have gone astray, those who call for disbelief and innovation, and their followers among the wrongdoers. His mercy towards them in the Hereafter means that He will save them from the greater terror (of the Day of Resurrection) and will command His angels to greet them with the glad tidings of Paradise and salvation from the Fire, which will only be because of His love for them and His kindness towards them. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "The Messenger of Allah and a group of his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, passed by a young child in the road. When his mother saw the people, she feared that her child may be crushed by the crowd, so she rushed forward, crying, "My son, my son!" She ran and picked him up, and the people said, 'O Messenger of Allah, she would never throw her child in the Fire.' The Messenger of Allah Jg convincingly said: $\text{tpj} \text{ }^* \text{j}$ "No, and Allah will not throw His beloved in the Fire. Its chain of narrators meets the conditions of the Two Sahihs, although none of the authors of the Six Books recorded it. But in Sahih Al-Bukhari it is recorded from the Commander of the faithful 'Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah saw a woman among the $\wedge$ Ahmad 3:104.

712 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr prisoners of war picking up her child, clasping the child to her breast and nursing him. The Messenger of Allah said: $\text{js- j-d jz'j jilt J} > \text{UjJj a}$ Do you think that this woman would throw her child into the Fire even though she is (physically) able to do so?» They said, "No." The Messenger of Allah Jg said: $\text{OlajJjj ;JA j}^* \text{ ill}$ «By A/D/i, Allah is more merciful towards His servants than this woman is to her child. n11 ' i Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be "Salami") The apparent meaning - and Allah knows best - is that then- greeting, from Allah on the Day that they meet Him, will be Salam, i.e., He will greet them with Salam, as He says elsewhere: $\text{yJ} < \text{k\#} (& \bullet)$ i(It will be said to them) : Salam - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful.) (36:58) Qatadah claimed that the meaning was that they would greet one another with Salam on the Day when they meet Allah in the Hereafter.¹² This is like the Ayah: $\text{« / ,1 }^* \text{ A. i/}^* \wedge \text{ i}$ Their way of request therein will be 'Glory to You, O Allah,' and 'Salam' will be their greetings therein! and the close of their request will be 'All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.') (10:10) 4And He has prepared for them a generous reward.) 111 Fath Al-Bari 10 :440 121 At-Jabari 20:280.

723 Surah 33 . Al-Ahzab (45 - 48) (Part-22) means Paradise and everything in it of food, drink, clothing, dwellings, physical pleasure, luxuries and delightful scenes, such as no eye has seen, no ear has heard and has never entered the mind of man. $\text{r}^* \text{ }_y \text{ Ljlli ' ' .Yu ti v? s ' / A }^* \text{ -t ' }^* \text{ St 2 t ' i}$ (fyu) $\text{ijjj 4j} \} \text{ l}$ ($\text{j}^* \text{ ju uOjJl 4tp}^{\wedge} \text{s4=y fh j}^* > \text{ J}^{\wedge} \text{=0b 445. 0}$ Prophet! Verily, We Juroe serif you as witness, and a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer, $\text{\$ i}$ 46. And as one who invites to Allah by His leave, and as a lamp

spreading light. 447. And announce to the believers the glad tidings, that they will have from Allah a great bounty 448. And obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and harm them not. And put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee The Attributes of the Messenger of Allah sfe Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Ata' bin Yasar said that he met 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Al-'As, may Allah be pleased with him, and said to him: "Tell me about the description of the Messenger of Allah jg in the Tawrah." He said, "Yes, by Allah, he was described in the Tawrah with some of the qualities with which he was described in the Qur'an: 'O Prophet! Verily, We have sent you as witness, and a bearer of glad tidings, and a warner, a saviour to the illiterate. You are My servant and My Messenger and I have called you Al-Mutawakkil (reliant). You are not harsh or severe, or noisy in the marketplaces. You do not repay evil with evil, but you overlook and forgive. Allah will not take your soul until you make straight those who have deviated and they say La ilaha iUaUdh, words with which blind eyes, deaf ears and sealed hearts will be opened'."111 It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari in the Books of Business and At- Tafsir.TM 111 Ahmad 2 :174. 121 Fath Al-B&ri4 :402 , 8 :449

714 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Wahb bin Munabbih said: "Allah revealed to one of the Prophets of the Children of Israel whose name was Sha^a (Isaiah); 'Stand up among your people the Children of Israel and I shall cause your tongue to utter (words of) revelation. I shall send an unlettered (Prophet) from among the illiterate (people). He will not be harsh or severe, or noisy in the marketplaces. If he were to pass by a lamp, it would not be extinguished, because of his tranquillity. If he were to walk on reeds no sound would be heard from under his feet. I will send him as a bearer of glad tidings and as a wamer, who will never utter immoral speech. Through him I will open blind eyes, deaf ears and sealed hearts. I will guide him to do every good deed and I will bestow upon him every noble characteristic. I will make tranquillity his garment, righteousness his banner, piety his conscience, wisdom his speech, truthfulness and loyalty his nature, tolerance and goodness his character, truth his way, justice his conduct, guidance his leader, Islam his nation. Ahmad is his name and through him I will guide people after they have gone astray, teach them after they have been ignorant, raise their status after they were nothing, make them known after they were unknown, increase the number (of followers of the truth) after they have been few, make them rich after they have been poor, and bring them together after they have been divided. Through him I will bring together different nations and hearts, and reconcile opposing desires. Through him I will save great numbers of people from their doom. I will make his Ummah the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; they will enjoin good and forbid evil, sincerely believing in Me Alone and accepting as truth all that My Messengers have brought. I shall inspire them to glorify, praise and magnify Me Alone in their places of worship and in their gatherings, when they lie down and when they return home. They will pray to Me standing and sitting. They will fight for the sake of Allah in ranks and armies. They will go forth from their homes by the thousand, seeking My pleasure, washing their faces and limbs, girding their loins. Their sacrifice will be their blood and their holy Book will be in their hearts. They will be like monks by night and like lions by day. Among the members of his family and his offspring I will make those who Eire foremost (in faith)

715 Surah 33 . Al-Ahzab (45 - 48) (Part-22) and believers in the truth and martyrs and righteous people. His Ummah after him will lead people with truth and establish justice therewith. I will give strength to those who support them and help those who pray for them, and I will inflict defeat upon those who oppose them or transgress against them or seek to take something from their hands. I will make them

the heirs of their Prophet, calling people to their Lord, enjoining what is good, forbidding what is evil, establishing regular prayer, paying the Zak&h and fulfilling their promises. Through them I will complete the goodness which I started with the first of them. This is My bounty which I bestow upon whomsoever I will, and I am the Possessor of great bounty.” 4as witness^ means, a witness to Allah’s Oneness, for there is no God except He, and a witness against mankind for their deeds on the Day of Resurrection. iand We bring you as a witness against these people> (4:41). This is like the Ayah: ,3^ iTjLf i that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger be a witness over you> (2:143). iand a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer.\$ means, a bearer of glad tidings to the believers of a great reward, and a warner to the disbelievers of a great punishment. JI iAnd as one who invites to Allah by His leave,> means, “you call mankind to worship their Lord because He has commanded you to do so.” *** Ibn Abi Hatim no. 17714.

716 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iand as a lamp spreading light. means, “the Message that you bring is as clear as the sun shining brightly, and no one can deny it except those who are stubborn.” <jvii'Z&i {And obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and harm them not means, ‘do not obey them and do not pay attention to what they say.’ iand harm them not.} means, ‘overlook and ignore them, for their matter rests entirely with Allah and He is sufficient for them (to deal with them).’ Allah says: 4' && ftS iAnd put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee.} 3 j5 « 33 *H} Hr- Cr*t>~** *-*£ o? 449. O you who believe! When you marry believing women, and then divorce them before you have sexual intercourse with them, no 'Iddah have you to count in respect of them. So, give them a present, and set them free in a handsome manner.} A Gilt and no [Iddah] for Women Who are divorced before Consummation of the Marriage This Ayah contains many rulings, including the use of the word Nikah for the marriage contract alone. There is no other Ayah in the Qur’an that is clearer than this on this point. It also indicates that it is permissible to divorce a woman before consummating the marriage with her. ibelieving women} this refers to what is usually the case, although there is no difference between a believing (Muslim) woman and a woman of the People of the Book in this regard.

according to scholarly consensus. Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, ‘Ali bin Al-Husayn Zayn-ul-‘Abidin and a group of the Salaf took this Ayah as evidence that divorce cannot occur unless it has been preceded by marriage, because Allah says. hP' lil< iWhen you marry believing women, and then divorce them The marriage contract here is followed by divorce, which indicates that the divorce cannot be valid if it comes first.111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “If someone were to say, ‘every woman I marry will ipso facto be divorced,’ this does not mean anything, because Allah says: ti! \cX ouH iO you who believe! When you marry believing women, and then divorce them....}.”™ It was also reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “Allah said, iWhen you marry believing women, and then divorce them.} Do you not see that divorce comes after marriage?” A Hadlth to the same effect was recorded from ‘Amr bin Shu'ayb from his father from his grandfather, who said: “The Messenger of Allah^ said: •Jul; h ft jyi, «There is no divorce for the son of Adam with regard to that which he does not possess This was recorded by Ahmad, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah. At-Tirmidhi said, “This is a Hasan Hadith, and it is the best thing that has been narrated on this matter.”13 * It At-Tabari 20:283. [2 * Recorded by Ibn Al-Mundhir and Ibn Abi Hatim . See Ad-Durr Al- Manthur 5:392. 131 Ahmad 2:207, Abu Dawud 2:240, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:355, Ibn Majah 1:660.

but bestow on them gift, the rich according to his means, and the poor according to his means, a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers of good.> (2:236) In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it was recorded that Sahl bin Sa'd and Abu Usayd, may Allah be pleased with them both, said, "The Messenger of Allah married Umaymah bint Sharahf, and when she entered upon him ^ he reached out his hand towards her, and it was as if she did not like that, so he told Abu Usayd to give her two garments."111 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said "If the dowry had been named, she would not be entitled to more than half, but if the dowry is not been named, he should give her a gift according to his means, and this is the "handsome manner."121 xul TL* Uj JiJ Lull -XXa* 0&J >UIU- ollj oGj liLf- oCj hiX'Sc jl' ^ J *Jj& \$ 1) p PJ 4p LJo} C» ji p "if^ gi disK 450. O Prophet! Verily, We have made lawful to you your wives, to whom you have paid their due (dowry), and those (slaves) whom your right hand possesses - whom Allah has given to you, and the daughters of your paternal uncles and the daughters of your paternal aunts and the daughters of your maternal uncles and the daughters of your maternal aunts who migrated with you, and a believing woman if she offers herself to the Prophet, and the Prophet wishes to marry her - a privilege for you only, not for the (rest of) the believers. Indeed We know what We have enjoined upon them about their wives and those (slaves) whom their right hands possess, in order that there should be no difficulty on you. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) 111 Fath Al-Bdri9 :269 At-Tabari 20:283.

The Women who are Lawful for the Prophet jg Allah says, addressing His Prophet jg that He has made lawful for him of women his wives to whom he has given the dowry, which is what is meant by "their due", which is used here, as was stated by Mujahid and others . The dowry which he gave to his wives was twelve and half 'Uqiyah (measures of gold) so they all received five hundred Dirhams except for Umm Habibah bint Abi Sufyan, to whom An-Najashi, may Allah have mercy on him, gave four hundred Dinars (on behalf of the Prophet jg) Safiyyah bint Huyay, whom he chose from among the prisoners of Khaybar, then he set her free, making her release her dowry. A similar case was that of Juwayriyah bint Al-Harith Al-Mustalaqiyyah - he paid off the contract to buy her freedom from Thabit bin Qays bin Shammas and married her. May Allah be pleased with them all. idxZ& -31% J&j; Cji i those (slaves) whom your right hand possesses whom Allah has given to you,} means, the slave-girls whom you took from the war booty are also permitted to you.' He owned Safiyyah and Juwayriyah, then he manumitted them and married them, and he owned Rayhanah bint Sham*un An-Nadariyyah and Mariyah Al- Qibtiyyah, the mother of his son Ibrahim, upon him be peace; they were both among the prisoners, may Allah be pleased with them. oL>J liljli. Cjbj vLf' } i and the daughters of your paternal uncles and the daughters of your paternal aunts and the daughters of your maternal uncles and the daughters of your maternal aunts This is justice which avoids going to either extreme, for the Christians do not marry a woman unless there are seven grandfathers between the man and the woman (i.e., they are very distantly related or not at all), and the Jews allow a man to marry his brother's daughter or his sister's daughter. So the pure and perfect Shari'ah came to cancel out the extremes of m At-Tabari 20 :284.

the Christians, and permitted marriage to the daughter of a paternal uncle or aunt, or the daughter of a maternal uncle or aunt, and forbade the excesses of the Jews who allowed marriage to the daughter of a brother or sister which is an abhorrent thing. J j'J oj 'Jif, i and a believing woman if she offers herself to the Prophet, and the Prophet wishes to marry her - a privilege for you only,) means, 'also lawful for you,

O Prophet, is a believing woman if she offers herself to you, to marry her without a dowry, if you wish to do so.' This Ayah includes two conditions. Imam Ahmad recorded from Sahl bin Sa'd As-Sa'idi that a woman came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ; and said, "O Messenger of Allah, verily, I offer myself to you {for marriage}." She stood there for a long time, then a man stood up and said, "O Messenger of Allah, marry her to me if you do not want to marry her." The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Do you have anything that you could give to her as a dowry?" He said, "I have only this garment of mine." The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "If you give her your garment, you will be left with no garment. Look for something." He said, "I do not have anything." He said: "Look for something, even if it is only an iron ring. So he looked, but he could not find anything. Then the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to him: "Do you have [know] anything of the Qur'an?" He said, "Yes, Surah such and such and Surah and such," he

named the Surahs. So, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "Marry her to you with what you know of the Qur'an." It was also recorded by (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) from the Hadith of Malik . Ibn Abi Hatim recorded a narration from his father that 'A'ishah said: "The woman who offered herself to the Prophet was Khawlah bint Hakim ." Al-Bukhari recorded that Aishah said, "I used to feel jealous of those women who offered themselves to the Prophet and I said. Would a woman offer herself?" When Allah revealed the Ayah: "You can postpone whom you will of them, and you may receive whom you will. And whomsoever you desire of those whom you have set aside, it is no sin on you" I said, I see that your Lord hastens to confirm your desires . Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said: "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not have any wife who offered herself to him." This was recorded by Ibn Jarir.¹⁵ In other words, he did not accept any of those who offered themselves to him, even though they were lawful for him - a ruling which applied to him alone. The matter was left to his own choice, as Allah says: "If the Prophet wishes to marry her" meaning, if he chooses to do so. "A privilege for you only, not for the (rest of) the believers." Ahmad 5:336. Fath Al-Bari⁹ :97 , Muslim 2 :1040 [3] Al-Bayhaqi 7:55. ,4) Fath Al-Bari⁸ :385 [S] At-Tabari 20:288.

Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (50) (Part-22) Ikrimah said: "This means, it is not permissible for anyone else to marry a woman who offers herself to him; if a woman offers herself to a man, it is not permissible for him (to marry her) unless he gives her something. ¹¹ This was also the view of Mujahid, Ash-Shalji and others.^[2] In other words, if a woman offers herself to a man, when he consummates the marriage, he has to give her a dowry like that given to any other woman of her status, as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ruled in the case of Barwa' bint Washiq when she offered herself in marriage; the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ruled that she should be given a dowry that was appropriate for a woman like her after her husband died. Death and consummation are the same with regard to the confirmation of the dowry, and the giving of a dowry appropriate to the woman's status in the case of those who offer themselves to men other than the Prophet is an established ruling. With regard to the Prophet ﷺ himself, he is not obliged to give a dowry to a woman who offers herself to him, even if he consummated the marriage, because he has the right to marry without a dowry, Wali (representative) or witnesses, as we have seen in the story of Zaynab bint Jahsh, may Allah be pleased with her. Qatadah said, concerning the Ayah: "A privilege for you only, not for the (rest of) the believers." > no woman has the right to offer herself to any man without a Wali or a dowry, except to the Prophet ﷺ. (31) Indeed We know what We have enjoined upon them about their wives and those (servants) whom their right hands possess,> Ubayy bin Ka'b,

Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Jarir said, concerning the Ayah: Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :63 1 ,2) At-Tabari 20:286, 287. At-Tabari 20:286.

724 Tajsir Ibt Kathir ilndeed We know what We have enjoined upon them about their wives} means, ‘concerning the limiting of their number to four free women, 1 11 and whatever they wish of slave-girls, and the conditions of a representative, dowery and witnesses to the marriage. This is with regard to the Ummah (the people), but We have granted an exemption in your case and have not imposed any of these obligations upon you.’ 4\L^> (JS& 4in order that there should be no difficulty on you. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) This is the end of volume seven. & Volume eight begins with Surat Al-Ahzab, Verse. 51. 111 At-Tabari 20:290.

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(ABRIDGED) (Surat Al-Ahzab, Verse 51 to the end of Surat Ad-Dukhan)

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsīr of Ibn Kathīr Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathīr mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction

of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said... - (‘Atiyah) Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn ‘Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn ‘Abbas, Ibn Mas‘ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ. - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ. All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet

but they report from companions of the Prophet ﷺ, while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, ‘Ata’ (bin Abi Rabah), ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi‘ bin Anas, Ash-Shahbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet ﷺ, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur’an’s revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki‘, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn ‘Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

The Tafsir of Surat Al-Ahzab

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4606–4631]

(Chapter - 33) — Continued— The Prophet ﷺ has the Choice of either accepting or rejecting Women who offer Themselves to Him Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, used to feel jealous of the women who offered

themselves to the Prophet She said, “Would a woman not feel shy to offer herself without any dowry?” Then Allah revealed the Ayah, 4 Cj4 id} Ztfij 51; j£) iYou can postpone whom you will of them, and you may receive whom you will.) She said, I think that your Lord is hastening to confirm your desire. 11 We have already stated that Al-Bukhari also recorded this. This indicates that what is meant by the word: 4postpone^ is delay, and 4c£i ^ iwhom you will of them) means, ‘of those who offer themselves to you.’ ce id} x&£f) i°nd you may receive whom you will.) means, ‘whoever you wish, you may accept, and whoever you wish, you may decline, but with regard to those whom you decline, you have the choice of going back to them later on and receiving them.’ Allah says: 4'-hlr- Xi cJ o-iM Ji>) 4And whomsoever you desire of those whom you have set aside, it is no sin on you (to receive her again).) Others said that what is meant by: 4inii ttii a4 >jr/) 4You can postpone (the turn of) whom you will of them,) means, tyour wives: there is no sin on you if you stop dividing your time equally between them, and delay the turn of one of them and bring forward the turn of another as you wish, and you

have intercourse with one and not another as you wish.’ This was narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, *** Ahmad 6:158. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :385

Qatadah, Abu Razln, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others. Nevertheless, the Prophet sg used to divide his time between them equally, hence a group of the scholars of Fiqh among the Shafils and others said that equal division of time was not obligatory for him jg and they used this Ayah as their evidence. Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah said: “The Messenger of Allah jg used to ask permission of us (for changing days) after this Ayah was revealed: £Ur Vi 4You can postpone whom you will of them, and you may receive whom you will. A\i’d whomsoever you desire of those whom you have set aside, it is no sin on you.” I (the narrator) said to her: “What did you say?” She said, “I said, ‘If it were up to me, 1 would not give preference to anyone with regard to you, O Messenger of Allah!’” * 1 ’ This Hadith indicates that what is meant in this Hadith from ‘A’ishah is that it was not obligatory on him to divide his time equally between his wives. The first Hadith quoted from her implies that the Ayah was revealed concerning the women who offered themselves to him. Ibn Jarir preferred the view that the Ayah was general and applies both to the women who offered themselves to him and to the wives that he already had, and that he was given the choice whether to divide him time among them or not.’2 ’ This is a good opinion which reconciles between the Hadiths. Allah says: jaj# ithat is better that they may be comforted and not grieved, and may all be pleased with wluit you give them.} meaning, ‘if they know that,t Allah has stated that there is no sin on you with regard to dividing your time. If you wish, you may divide you time and if you do not wish, you need not divide your time, there is no sin on you no matter which you 111 Path Al-Bari 8:385. 121 Al-Tabari 20:304.

do. Therefore if you divide your time between them, this will be your choice, and not a duty that is enjoined upon you, so they will feel happy because of that and will recognize your favor towards them in sharing your time equally among themand being fair to all of them.’ iAUah knows what is in your hearts.} means, ‘He knows that you are more inclined towards some ofthem than others, which you cannot avoid.’ Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said: “The Messenger of Allah used to divide his time between his wives fairly and treat them equally, then he said: VjXX UJ * .iuii UJ Jki lii «0 Allah, I have done as much as I can with regard to what is under my control , so do not blame me for that which is under Your control and not mine . (li It was also recorded by the four Sunan compilers. After the words “so do not blame me for that which is under Your control and not mine,” Abu Dawud’s report adds the phrase: Jill; LLi •&> «So do not blame me for that which is under Your control and not mine.* meaning matters of the heart.12 , Its chain of narration is Sahih, and all themen in its chain are reliable. Then this phrase is immediately followed by the words, icx 4And Allah is Ever All-Knowing,} i.e., ofinnermost secrets, iMost Forbearing.} meaning, He overlooks and forgives. C cc Sr k' c5 Vj Xu lOf S& f} Ahmad 6:144. ,2) Abu Dawud 2:601, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:294, An-Nasal 7:63, Ibn Majah 1 : 633

21Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (52) (Part-22) 452. It is not lawful far you (to marry other) women after this, nor to change them far other wives even though their beauty attracts you, except those whom your right hand possesses. And Allah is Ever a Watcher over all things. The Reward of His Wives for choosing to stay with the Messenger^ More than one of the scholars, such as Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Zayd, Ibn Jarir and others * stated that this Ayah was revealed as a reward to the wives of

the Prophet expressing Allah's pleasure with them for their excellent decision in choosing Allah and His Messenger jgg and the Home of the Hereafter, when the Messenger of Allah gave them the choice, as we have stated above. When they chose the Messenger of Allah their reward was that Allah restricted him to these wives, and forbade him to marry anyone else or to change them for other wives, even if he was attracted by their beauty - apart from slave-girls and prisoners of war, with regard to whom there was no sin on him. Then Allah lifted the restriction stated in this Ayah and permitted him to marry more women,*2 * but he did not marry anyone else, so that the favor of the Messenger of Allah towards them would be clear. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: "The Messenger of Allah jg£ did not die until Allah permitted (marriage to other) women for him."*3 ' It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal in their Simons.*4 On the other hand, others said that what was meant by the Ayah, 4& 'ot i'Qji£ U. 4It is not lawful far you (to marry other) women after this, means, 'after the description We have given of the women who are lawful for you, those to whom you have given their dowery, At-Tabari 20:297, 299. * Ahmad 6:41 * See SuratAl-Ahzab 33 :50 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :78 , An-Nasal 6 :56

b\ 'ij li)i c£ ^ ^ .^ . v de Jis*- s^r <<& <i' "by5 ol CS^ Cy j^>hl _/4^ (*^=*i'j yk: sly a; ijiii o) ^Tyll-ke-
 <if xc jL^=> j^J'i jl IjJ a»jJu S; /-“titjJ \y^i j Vj 4^tU^ ^ t£S i£ 453 . O you who believe! Enter not the Prophet's houses, unless permission is given to you for a meal, (and then) not (so early as) to waitfor its preparation. But when you are invited, enter, and when you have taken your meal, disperse without sitting for a talk. Verily, such (behavior) annoys the Prophet, and he is shy of (asking) you (to go); but Alldh is not shy of (telling you) the truth. And when you ask (his wives) for anything you want, ask them from behind a screen, that is purer for your hearts and for their hearts. And it is not (right) for you that you should annoy Allah's Messenger, nor that you should ever marry his wives after him (his death). Verily, with Allah that shall be an enormity.} 454. Whether you reveal anything or conceal it, verily, Allah is Ever All-Knower ofeverything.} The Etiquette ofentering the Houses ofthe ProphetM and theCommand ofHijab This is the Ayah of Hijab, which includes several legislative rulings and points of etiquette. This is one of the cases where the revelation confirmed the opinion of TJmar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, as it was reported in the Two Sahihs that he said: "My view coincided with that of my Lord in three things. I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, why do you not take Maqam Ibrahim as a place of prayer?' Then Allah revealed: 4fa -j& m 4And take you (people) the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim as a place ofprayer} (2:125) And I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, both righteous and immoral people enter upon your wives, so why do you not screen

them?' Then Allah revealed the Ayah of Hijab. And I said to the wives of the Prophet jg when they conspired against him out ofjealousy, i&t£ c# 4;^ may be if he divorced you (all) that his Lord will give him instead ofyou, wives better than you> (66:5), and this is what Allah revealed." In a report recorded by Muslim, the prisoners of Badr are mentioned, and this is a fourth matter (in which the view of TJmar coincided with that of his Lord).*21 Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said: "Umar bin Al-Khattab said: 'O Messenger of Allah, both righteous and immoral people enter upon you, so why not instruct the Mothers of the believers to observe Hijab?' Then Allah revealed the Ayah of Hijab. Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "When the Messenger of Allah jfe married Zaynab bint Jahsh, he invited the people to eat, then they sat talking. When he wanted to get up, they did not get up. When he saw that, he got up anyway, and some of them got up, but three

people remained sitting. The Prophet wanted to go in, but these people were sitting, then they got up and went away. I came and told the Prophet that they had left, then he came and entered. I wanted to follow him, but he put the screen between me and him. Then Allah revealed, *J%\$!£5 v \p: > «»;!» b) £} \j ilil 40 you who believe! Enter not the Prophet's houses, unless permission is given to you for a meal, (and then) not (so early as) to waitfor its preparation. But when you are invited, enter, and wlten you have taken your meal, disperse. * 1 * Fath Al-Bari 1 :60, Muslim 4:1765. * Muslim 4 :1765. 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :387 141 Fath Al-B&ri 8:387.*

25Surah 33. Al-Ahzdb (53 - 54) (Part-22) Al-Bukhari also recorded this elsewhere. 1 11 It was also recorded by Muslim and An-Nasal.*2 Then Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said: “The Prophet married Zaynab bint Jahsh with (a wedding feast of) meat and bread. I sent someone to invite people to the feast, and some people came and ate, then left. Then another group came and ate, and left. 1 invited people until there was no one left to invite. I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, I cannot find anyone else to invite.’ He jg said, \y*i “Take away thefood . There were three people left who were talking in the house. The Prophet jg went out until he came to the apartment of ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, and he jg said. •May peace be upon you, members of the household, and the mercy and blessings ofAllah. She said, ‘And upon you be peace and the mercy of Allah. How did you find your (new) wife, O Messenger of Allah? May Allah bless you.’ He went round to the apartments of all his wives, and spoke with them as he had spoken with ‘A’ishah, and they spoke as ‘A’ishah had spoken. Then the Prophet jg came back, and those three people were still talking in the house. The Prophet jg was extremely shy, so he went out and headed towards ‘A’ishah’s apartment. I do not know whether I told him or someone else told him when the people had left, so he came back, and when he was standing with one foot over the threshold and the other foot outside, he placed the curtain between me and him, and the Ayah of Hijab was revealed.”*3 This was recorded only by Al-Bukhari among the authors of the Six Books, apart from An-Nasal, in Al-Yaum wal-Laulah.*4 iEnter not the Prophet's houses,} the believers were prohibited Path Al-Bari 1 1 :24 Muslim 2 :1050, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 : 435. * Fath Al-Bari 8:388. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :75

4without sitting for a talk.} meaning, as those three people did who stayed behind and chatted, and forgot themselves to such an extent that this caused inconvenience for the Messenger of Allah jg as Allah says: 4 Verily, such (behavior) annoys the Prophet, and he is shy of (asking) you (to go);} It was said that what was meant was, your entering his houses without permission causes him inconvenience and annoyance, but he did not like to forbid them to do so because he felt too shy,’ until Allah revealed that this was forbidden. Allah says: U^ v%} ibut Allah is not shy of (telling you) the truth.} meaning, “this is why He is forbidding and prohibiting you from doing that.’ Then Allah says: tllf ot tyf} 4And when you ask (his wives) for anything you want, ask themfrom behind a screen,} meaning, just as it is forbidden for you to enter upon them, it is forbidden for you to look at them at all. If anyone of you has any need to take anything from them, he should not look at them, but he should ask for whatever he needs from behind a screen.’ Prohibition of annoying the Messenger ^ and the Statement that His Wives are Unlawful for the Muslims 4 vJ ijoJi o; J Vj i/j}5 o' Cj} it od==> 4And it is not (right) for you that you slwuld annoy Allah's Messenger, nor that you should ever marry his wives after him Otis death). Verily, with Allah that shall be an enormity.}

29 Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (55) (Part-22) rJj 'mm m ^ ^=&Xa%SjSSjjS&jA&)Hjhf\<—A. ,0> jpP' 3 Ot^ £^»r^ 50 H) oty*-i Vj 6ft^ "i> •xA % i*rA{ &4 sju c % Itfr & £>* £f d% St £fl& ,a&^ <55. It is no sin on them before their fathers, or their sons, or their brothers, or their brothers' sons, or the sons of their sisters, or their own (believing) women, or their (female) slaves. And (O ladies) have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Witness over everything.^ Relatives before Whom a Woman does not need to observe Hijab When Allah commands women to observe Hijab in front of men to whom they are not related, He explains who are the relatives before whom they do not need to observe Hijab. This is like the exceptions stated in Surat An-Nur, where Allah says: \$ 3' tCp* 'J <£*>\$- S J+jSA X# S Jff-i S bftA If* S S+ijH & \$ S SSS & ') jAA -/ SSif Jf Jj* ji- A p±j£i, ciM'j tj^ru'iar^t^iic. Sc' '.K\-' 'if ^ > *>r >> . ^X-IW ^ g. ' w-i, r •"*, I. S ' 'suy.' - -i 4And not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husbands' fathers, or their sons, or their husbands' sons, or their brothers, or their brothers' sons, or

their sisters' sons, or their women, or their right hand possessions, or the Tabi'in among men who do not have desire, or small children who are not aware of the nakedness of women. (24:31). The Ayah contains more detail than this, which we have already discussed in the Tafsir of the Ayah and do not need to repeat here. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ash-Sha'bi and 'Ikrimah said concerning the Ayah, <lr& '4 ^ is no sin on them before their fathers...) I said, "What about the paternal uncle and the maternal uncle - why are they not mentioned?" He said: "Because they may describe her to their sons, so it is disliked for a woman to remove her covering in front of her paternal uncle or maternal uncle. 4or their own women,) means that they do not have to observe Hijab in front of other believing women. ior their (female) slaves.) Said bin Al-Musayyib said: "This means female slaves only." This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. dA ft 4And (O ladies) have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Witness over everything.) means, and fear Him in private and in public, for He witnesses all things and nothing is hidden from Him, so think of the One Who is always watching. i dS \$4 yjf £ 3jU. 'frjz ft ll) 456. Allah sends His Salah on the Prophet, and also His angels (do so). O you who believe! Send your Salah on him, and greet him with Taslim.) m At-Tabari 20:318.

The Command to say Salah upon the Prophet Al-Bukhari said: "Abu Al-'Aliyah said: "Allah's Salah is His praising him before the angels, and the Salah of the angels is their supplication." Ibn 'Abbas said: "They send blessings."111 Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi said: "This was narrated from Sufyan Ath-Thawri and other scholars, who said: The Salah of the Lord is mercy, and the Salah of the angels is their seeking forgiveness."121 There are Mutawatir Hadiths narrated from the Messenger of Allah jg commanding us to send blessings on him and how we should say Salah upon him. We will mention as many of them as we can, if Allah wills, and Allah is the One Whose help we seek. In his Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Ka*b bin TJjah said, "It was said, 'O Messenger of Allah, with regard to sending Saldm upon you, we know about this, but how about Salah?' He ig said: ' ^ jl jLfUl Ji c-SjU ui jl Juj j Ju, IijU 141)1 Jjui » till) "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are the Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious. O Allah, send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim, venly You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious."s"t3 l Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Abi Layla said that Kah bin TJjah met him and said, "Shall I not give you a gift? The Messenger of Allah jg came out to us and we said, 'O Messenger of

Allah! We know how to send Salam upon you, but how can we send Salah?' He said: Fath Al-Bari 8 : 392 . TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi2 :6 1 Fath Al-Bari 8 :392 .

jT \LSj\j ius ijUU> (j! jUUv* ^jip JJUJ lvbv« Ju-p- JjUl kp— «Say; "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are the Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious. O Allah, send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious This Hadith has been recorded by the Group in their books with different chains of narration. Another Hadith Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "We said, 'O Messenger of Allah, this is the Sal&m upon you, but how do we send Salah upon you?' He said: I (Jl ,JU cUb. US iUIJjUU} hXS fUJ^ JU> J-SjC US ijUUi Ji ^ aSay: "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad, Your servant and Messenger, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, and send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon thefamily ofMuhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon thefamily ofIbrahim Abu Salih narrated that Layth said: ji oSju us ijUsu Ji bu «Upon Muhammad and upon the family ofMuhammad as You sent Your blessings upon thefamily ofIbrShim .» Ibrahim bin Hamzah told that, Ibn Abi Hazim and Ad- Darawardi told, that Yazld, i.e., Ibn Al-Had said: J~SjU US Jlj jU>w« Jj\jj 1 c-;b US J> i «As You sent Your Salah upon Ibrahim, and send Your blessings upon Muhammad and the family of Muhammad, as

33Surah 33. Al-Ahzab (56) (Part-22) You sent Your blessings upon Ibrahim and the family of Ibrahim.>1" This was also recorded by An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.¹² Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Humayd As-Sa'idi that they said: "O Messenger of Allah, how can we send Salah upon you?" He jg; said. Jl C-5jU t*5* 4jjiJ A>-'jjj "Say: "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and his wives and offspring, as You sent Your Salah upon Ibrahim, and send Your blessings upon Muhammad and his wives and offspring, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious."**3 It was also recorded by the rest of the Group, apart from At- Tirmidhi. Another Hadith Muslim recorded that Abu Mas*ud Al-Ansari said: "We came to the Messenger of Allah and we were with Sa'd bin TJbadah. Bashir bin Sa'd said to him, 'Allah has commanded us to send Salah upon you, O Messenger of Allah. How can we send Salah upon you?' The Messenger of Allah jg remained quiet for so long that we wished that he had not asked him, then the Messenger of Allah jg said: j! j^jjl Jl c- 0-5jU 115 iJl l j xL>v JjIjj ^ ji Lis vlijl 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :392 [2* An-Nasal 3 :49, Ibn Majah 1 :292. 131 Ahmad 5 :424 * Fath Al-Bari 11 :157, Muslim 1 :306, Abu Dawud 1 :600, An-Nasal 3:49, Ibn M&jah 1 :293.

"Say : "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, and send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon thefamily ofMuhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim among all people, verily You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious." And the Salam is as you knowj",1) This was also recorded by Abu Dawud, An-Nasal, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Jarir. At-Tirmidhi said, "It is Hasan Sahih."*2] Saying Saldh upon the Prophet jgg before the Supplication Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi reported the following Hadith and graded it Sahih\ An-Nasal, Ibn Khuzaymah and Ibn Hibban recorded in their Sahihs that Fadal bin TJbayd, may Allah be pleased with him, said: "The Messenger of Allah jg heard a man making supplication in his prayer when he had not praised Allah or said Salah upon the Prophet

jg. The Messenger of Allah said: o IJLa tThis man is rushing . » Then he called him over and said, to him or to someone else, p ' fpi tvip j>-j 3* <*>' .^>1^ ixdi Lj J-jo *jIJ «When any one of you supplicates, let him start by praising and glorifying Allah, may He be exalted, then let him send Salah upon the Prophet, and after that let him make supplication as he wishes.»”131 111 Muslim 1 :305. I2 ' Abu Dawud 1 :600, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:84, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :436, At-Tabari 20 :32 1 Ahmad 6:18, Abu Dawud 2:162, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:450, An- Nasat 3 :44, Ibn Khuzaymah 1 :351 , Ibn Hibban 3 :308.

The Virtue of saying Salah upon the Prophet^ Another Hadith At-Tirmidhi recorded that Ubayy bin Ka*b said: “When two thirds of the night had passed, the Messenger of Allah jg would get up and say, iU- iZity iSti 1 2ii ij^sii !,>&i)4J Ui ja}\ 4o Lw «O people, remember Allah, remember Allah, the first blast of the Trumpet has come and will be followed by the second blast, death has come with all its horrors, death has come with all its horrors.*” Ubayy said, “I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, I send a lot of Salah upon you, how much of my prayer should be Salah upon you?’ He said, Lit ^Whatever you want.* I said, ‘A quarter?’ He said, •ill oij It 4vL4 Ui ^Whatever you want, but if you increase it, it will be better for you. I said, ‘Half?’ He said, oij i>t ni-Li ^Whatever you want, but if you increase it, it will be better for you. I said, ‘Two thirds?’ He said, (till jj)* j[i 4eh U® ^Whatever you want, but if you increase it, it will be better for you. I said, ‘Should I make my whole prayer for you?’ He said, 4iU 4 4il<^> »This would be sufficient to relieve your distress and earn you forgiveness of your sins.*”

Then he said: “This is a Hasan HadLith. 1 ' Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Talhah said that the Messenger of Allah sg came one day looking happy. They said, “O Messenger of Allah, we see that you look happy.” He said, ^ £ :Jlii kiLUJl Jji> jt^^ j&J v'j * dU JiL vi ikif^ idi JL; «Jb :cJi di. vldb Vi 'The angel came to me and told me, "O Muhammad, would it not please you if your Lord, may He be glorified, says: ‘No member of your Ummah sends Salah upon you but I send Salah upon him tenfold, and no member of your Ummah sends greetings of Saldm upon you but I send greetings of Salam upon him tenfold?’” I said, "Of course .”>|21 This was also recorded by An-Nasal.’3’ Another Chain of Narration Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Talhah Al-Ansari said: “One morning the Messenger of Allah jg was in a cheerful mood and looked happy. They said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, this morning you are in a cheerful mood and look happy.’ He said, <il ii'&o kiLit : JU i j ijij ol ij jLc- d jj iolw jZj- <j- l>xaj tj j <J “0/ course just now someone [an angel] came to me from my Lord and said, "Whoever among your Ummah sends Salah upon you, Allah will record for him ten good deeds and will erase for him ten evil deeds, and will raise his status by ten degrees, and will return his greeting with something similar to This is also a good chain, although they (Al-Bukhari and ,l) Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:152. Ahmad 4:30. 131 An-Nasal 3:44. '4 ' Ahmad 4 :29

Muslim) did not report it. Another Hadith Muslim, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “The Messenger of Allah jg said: If; fSi- <ill Jui 5<i>-l iWhoever sends one Salah upon me, Allah will send ten upon him. At-Tirmidhi said: “This is a SahOi Hasan Hadith. On the same topic, narrations come from ‘Abdur-Rahman bin ‘Awf, ‘Amir bin Rabl'ah, ‘Ammar, Abu Talhah, Anas and Ubayy bin Ka-b.”111 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg said: ‘5*^* ijt ij! ****’ siSj uS dj;\ ot VI IfJli i oSend Salah upon me, for this is Zakah for you, and ask Allah to grant me Al-Wastlah, for it is a position in the highest

part of Paradise which only one man will attain, and I hope that I will be the one. This was recorded only by Ahmad.² Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Husayn bin 'Ali said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *“If the miser is the one in whose presence I am mentioned, then he does not send Salah upon me.”* Abu Said said: Muslim 1 :306, Abu Dawud 2:184, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 2:608, An-Nasal 3 :50 ' Ahmad 2 :365. See also Muslim no. 384.

“...and he does not send Salah upon me.” This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who then said: *“This Hadith is Hasan Gharib, Sahih.”* Another Hadith At-Tirmidhi recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: *“The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: ‘PA JP* JPj jPj ‘{Aj j}I* Iljil '—*1 ji-fJJ til J*» pj jLatj «2Uji JSUi' *May he be humiliated, the man in whose presence I am mentioned and he does not send Salah upon me; may he be humiliated, the man who sees the month of Ramadan come and go, and he is not forgiven; may he be humiliated, the man whose parents live to old age and they do not cause him to be granted admittance to Paradise.*”* Then he (At-Tirmidhi) said: *“Hasan Gharib.”* Occasions for saying Salah upon Him[^] It is reported that we should send blessings upon him on many occasions, such as following the call to prayer, as in the Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Al-'As, who said that he heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: *Jiii Jb,& JLip fy 'A* r ^ pi ni v &ii j Zp j a 1 p i* 4 nipillii 4* oi»- iL-p i'p. Jt- IP* *j* ut jjs\ of p~j\j ijiii jCp *When you hear the Mu'adhdhin, repeat what he says, then send Salah upon me, for whoever sends Salah upon me, Allah will send Salah upon him tenfold. Then ask Allah to grant me Al-Wasilah, which is a status in Paradise to which only one of ^ Ahmad 1 :201 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :531 131 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :530*

the servants of Allah will be entitled, and I hope that I will be the one. Whoever asks Allah for Al-Wastlah for me, it will be permitted for me to intercede for him.” This was recorded by Muslim, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal.^{*21} Other occasions when we should send Salah upon the Prophet include when entering or exiting the Masjid, because of the Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from Fatimah, the daughter of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who said: *“When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ entered the Masjid, he would send Salah and Salam upon Muhammad, and say, ij? ^*0 ij.y*j j**' «0 Allah, forgive me my sins and open for me the gates of Your mercy» When he exited, he would send Salah and Salam upon Muhammad, and say, «0 Allah, forgive me my sins and open for me the gates of Your bounty»*^{*3} ' We should also send Salah upon him during the Funeral prayer. The Sunnah is to recite Surat Al-Fatihah following the first Takbir, to send Salah upon the Prophet ﷺ during the second Takbir, to make supplication for the deceased during the third Takbir, and in the fourth Takbir to say, *“O Allah, do not deprive us of his reward, and do not test us after him.”* Ash-Shafil, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Abu Umamah bin Sahl bin Hunayf was told by one of the Companions of the Prophet that the Sunnah in the funeral prayer is for the Imam to pronounce the Takbir, then to recite Surat Al-Fatihah silently after the first Takbir, then to send Salah upon the Prophet ﷺ then to offer sincere supplication for the deceased, but not to recite any Qur'an in any of the 111 Ahmad 2 :168. ^{*21} Muslim 1 :288, Abu Dawud 1 :359, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1 :83, An-Nasal 2 :25. 131 Ahmad 6 :282

Takbirs, then to conclude by saying Salam silently. * An-Nasal also recorded this from Abu Umamah, who said, *This is from the Sunnah,*” and he mentioned it.^[2] According to the correct view, such a statement reported from a Companion carries the ruling of Marfa ^{*3} It is recommended to conclude supplications with Salah upon the Prophet ﷺ. At-Tirmidhi recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said: *“A*

supplication remains suspended between heaven and earth and does not ascend any further until you send Salah upon your Prophet.”*4 This was also narrated by Mu'adh bin Al-Harith from Abu Qurrah from Said bin Al-Musayyib from Umar, as a saying of the Prophet jg.*5 ' It was also recorded by Razln bin Mu'awiyah in his book, where he also attributed it to the Prophet jg reporting that he said: jlj a ,U —! I oy llpjJts Jjl t^lp ljXS> jliS «A supplication remains suspended between heaven and earth and does not ascend any further until a person sends Salah on me. Do not treat me like a spare water container, send Salah upon me at the beginning of your supplication, at the end and in the middle. Sending Salah upon the Prophet jg is even more strongly encouraged in the Qunut supplication. Ahmad, the Sunan compilers, Ibn Khuzaymah, Ibn Hibban and Al-Hakim recorded that Al-Hasan bin 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “The Messenger of Allah jg taught me some words to say during Al-Witr. * Musnad Ash-Shafi'ip . 210 An-Nasal 4:75. * Here the meaning is that the statement; “this is the Sunnah” coming from a Companion means that it carries the ruling of having come from the Prophet jg himself. TuhfatAl-Ahwardhi2:610. *s * TakhrijAl-Kashshafby Ibn Hajar p. 137. Jami'Al-Usul 4:155.

JJu N *Jlj l jilt- V _* iJijU 1oljl U fcllj» «cJu5j l2j dijlJ tcJSU »"0 Allah, guide me along with those whom You have guided, grant me health along with those to whom You have granted health, be an ally to me along with those to whom You are an ally, and bless me far that which You have bestowed. Protect me from the evil You have decreed, far verily You decree and none can decree over You. Verily, he whom You show allegiance to is never abased and he whom You take as an enemy is never honored and mighty, O our Lord, blessed and Exalted are Yoh."» In his Sunan, An-Nasal has the addition, iu i yy i"and may Allah bless Muhammad."* at the end of this QimutJ It is also recommended to say plenty of Salah upon him on Friday and on the eve of Friday.121 Imam Ahmad recorded that Aws bin Aws Ath-Thaqafi, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “The Messenger of Allah sg said: a jU i<j 3^aJl I i Aon ,5ill •One of the best of your days is Friday; on this day Adam was created and died, on this day the Trumpet (Sur) will be blown and all will have swoon away. So on this day send plenty of Salah upon me, far your Salah will be presented to me. They said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, how will they be shown to you after your body has dispersed into the earth?’ He said, SLlii jst b\ ji- '{fr 2>l !>l» ^Allah has forbidden the earth to consume the bodies of the *** Ahmad 1:199, Abu Dawud 2:133, Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 2:562, An- Nasal 3:248, Ibn M&jah 1:372, Ibn Khuzaymah 2:151, Ibn Hibban 2 :148 , Al-Hakim 3:172. I2 ' Thursday night

Prophets,n”*1 This was also recorded by Abu Dawud, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah, and it was graded Sahih by Ibn Khuzaymah, Ibn Hibban, Ad-Daraqutni and An-Nawawi in Al-Adhkar.^ p 2% 4 'if if^\$!, [» ££ C^ 457. Verily, those who annoy Allah and His Messenger, Allah has cursed them in this world and in the Hereafter, and has prepared for them a humiliating torment.} 458. And those who annoy believing men and women undeservedly, they bear the crime of slander and plain sin.} WhoeverannoysAllahandHisMessenger is cursed in this World and the Hereafter Here, Allah warns and threatens those who annoy Him by going against His commands and doing that which He has forbidden, and who persist in doing so, and those who annoy His Messenger ^ by accusing him of having faults or shortcomings - Allah forbid. 'Ikrimah said that the Ayah iVerily, those who annoy Allah and His Messenger,} was revealed concerning those who make pictures or images.*3 In The Two Sahihs, it is reported that Abu Hurayrah said: “The Messenger of Allah 3g§ said: *ltfj& Jil 'j&\ ub Ll,

’J,\ :fej> %l j>;» «Allah says: "The son of Adam annoys Me by inveighing against time, but I am time, for I cause the alternation of night and day."**”w

The meaning of this Hadith is that in the Jahiliyyah they used

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4631–4646]

’ Ahmad 4:8. * Abu Dawud 1:635, An-Nasa’i 3:91, Ibn Majah 1:524, Ibn Khuzaymah 3:118, Ibn Hibban 2:132, An-Nawawi 97 At-Tabari 20:322. I4 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :437 , Muslim 4 :1762

Sarah 33. Al-Ahzab (57 - 58) (Part-22) 43 to say, “How bad time is, it has done such and such to us!” They used to attribute the deeds of Allah to time, and inveigh against it, but the One Who did that was Allah, may He be exalted. So, He forbade them from this. Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said that the Ayah, 4Verily, those who annoy Allah and His Messenger,} was revealed about those who slandered the Prophet jg over his marriage to Safiyyah bint Huyay bin Akhtab. The Ayah appears to be general in meaning and to apply to all those who annoy him in any way, because whoever annoys him annoys Allah, just as whoever obeys him obeys Allah. The Threat to ThoseWho fabricate Slander C _Ai> ciJlS C(Mj} 4And those who annoy believing men and women undeservedly,} means, they attribute to them things of which they are innocent, which they do not know and do not do. 4<J% ££ £} 4they bear the crime of slander and plain sin.} This is the most serious slander, to tell or transmit things about the believing men and women that they have not done, in order to bring shame upon them and accuse them of shortcomings. Among those to whom the description most applies are those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers, followed by the Rafidites who accuse the Companions of shortcomings and faults of which Allah has stated that they are innocent, and describe them as the opposite of what Allah has said about them. Allah, may He be exalted, has told us that He is pleased with the Migrants and Ansar, and has praised them, but these foolish and ignorant people inveigh against them and accuse them of shortcomings, and say |i| At-Tabari 20:323. See the section on reports at the beginning of this book.

things about them that they did not do and could never have done. In reality, their hearts are misguided, for they condemn those who deserve praise and praise those who deserve condemnation. Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that it was said: “O Messenger of Allah, what is backbiting (Ghibah)?” He said, Cf; IL i)U-l ilt is when you mention something about your brother that he dislikes . It was asked, “But what if what I say about my brother is true?” He said. isi JjZ U jii jj} i-clil Jit Jyu U jls jj» If it is true, then you have committed backbiting (Ghibah) about him, and if it is not true, then you have slandered Wm.il This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Hasan Sahih.”l2t J lii uU’i Or?* OJirtP’ it-JijV ji oi> cM Oi iyu2 tHjf 4i> jfjJ 459. O Prophet! Tell your wives and your daughters and the women of the believers to draw their Jaldbib over their bodies. That will be better that they should be known so as not to be annoyed. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 460. If the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease, and those who spread false news among the people in Al- Madinah stop not. We shall certainly let you overpower them, then they will not be able to stay in it as your neighbors but a Abu Dawud 5:192. Muslim no . 2589 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :63

45Siirah 33. Al-Ahzdb (59 - 62) (Part-22) little while. 462 . Accursed, they shall be seized wherever found, and killed with a (terrible) slaughter.} 462. That was the way of Allah in the case of those who

passed away of old, and you will not find any change in the way of Allah.} The Command of Hijab Here Allah tells His Messenger &g to command the believing women - especially his wives and daughters, because of then- position of honor - to draw their Jilbabs over their bodies, so that they will be distinct in their appearance from the women of the Jdhiliyyah and from slave women. The Jilbab is a Rida', worn over the Khimar. This was the view of Ibn Mas'ud, 'Ubaydah, Qatadah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Said bin Jubayr, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and others. It is like the Izar used today. Al-Jawhari said: "The Jilbab is the outer wrapper." *Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that Allah commanded the believing women, when they went out of their houses for some need, to cover their faces from above their heads with the Jilbab, leaving only one eye showing. Muhammad bin Sirin said, "I asked Ubaydah As-Salmani about the Ayah it Opk 4to draw their Jalabib over their bodies.} He covered his face and head, with just his left eye showing."*2 4That will be better that they slwuld be known so as not to be annoyed.} means, if they do that, it will be known that they are free, and that they are not servants or whores. 111 At-Tabari 20:324. * At-Tabari 20:325.

46 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. means, with regard to what happened previously during the days of Jahiliyyah, when they did not have any knowledge about this. A Stern Warning to the Evil Hypocrites Then Allah issues a warning to the hypocrites, those who, make an outward display of faith while concealing their disbelief, 4those in whose hearts is a disease,} 'Ikrimah and others said that this refers to adulterers in this instance. 1 ' iand those who spread false news among the people in Al Madinah} means, those who say that the enemy has come and war has started, which is a lie and a fabrication. Unless they give up these actions and return to the truth, 4We shall certainly let you overpower them,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "We will give you power over them."*2 * Qatadah said: "We will incite you against them."*3 ' As-Suddî said: "We will inform you about them." ithen they will not be able to stay in it} means, in Al-Madlnah, ibut a little while. Accursed. . .} 'this describes their state while they are in Al-Madlnah for this short time before they are expelled and sent far away.' At-Tabari 20:326. * At-Tabari 20:328. At-Tabari 20:328.

jAj Cts*4 0 VuSriisjiSli Qp L^-)4UiJi5(jo^ly ttU->4Jll' l>j'» ><>"/.< i> "i-x. *. '."^(*V£"t "ui's c'l'irfi" *<"iS, <*&» i*» i ".f-r •r.r-c'T iiiSSatv^a 41,J jjjcy» ^tfiey shall be seized wherever found,> means, 'they will be attacked, because they are so weak and so few,' iand killed with a (terrible) slaughter.) Then Allah says: (a !>£• ^ 4jj iThat was the way of Allah in the case of those who passed away of old,) meaning, this is how Allah dealt with the hypocrites when they persisted in hypocrisy and disbelief and did not give it up; He incited the believers against them and caused them to prevail over them. f& iLil 3j) iand you will not find any change in the way of Allah.) means, the way in which Allah deals with this does not alter or change. icLlll JJ ty j# Lfiig LiJ Ji i*LJl jc- JXM y* Oj^f. Cd tji uui£- pi j4j <®i il Ol "C; j#j 0.1; & lOI Eft Sj>; a ,^w-j O' j£25 ^ gJO, T£ b:T^ OH *>V/ ^ >'

463. People ask you concerning the Hour, say: "The knowledge of it is with Allah only. What do you know? It may be that the Hour is near!"} 464. Verily, Allah has cursed the disbelievers, and has prepared for them aflaming Fire.} 465. Wherein they will abide forever, and they will find neither a a protector nor a helper.} 466. On the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh, would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger."} 467. And they will say: "Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the way."} 468. "Our Lord!

Give them double torment and curse them with a mighty curse!"} No One knows when the Day of Resurrection will come except Allah Here Allah tells His Messenger jg that he cannot know when the Hour will come, and if people ask him about that, He instructs him to refer the matter to Allah, may He be exalted, as Allah says in Surat Al-A'raf even though that was revealed in Makkah and this Surah was revealed in Al-Madinah. Allah continues to tell him to refer this matter to the One Who knows about it, but He tells him that it is at hand, as He says: 4{tfi icLlif Jj Cj} 4What do you know? It may be that the Hour is near!} This is like the Ayat 4S:^ £\$} 4The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft: asunder.} [54:1] 4Draws near for mankind their reckoning, while they turn away in heedlessness .} [21:1]

3} 4The Event (the Hour) ordained by Allah will come to pass, so seek not to hasten it} [16:1). The Curse on the Disbelievers and its Eternity and their Regret Then Allah says: iVerily, Allah has cursed the disbelievers,} means, He has distanced them from His mercy. iand has prepared for them a flaming Fire (Hell).} means, in the Hereafter. iWherein they will abide forever,} means, they will stay there forever and ever, never leaving or finding relief from it. 'ij iand they will find neither a protector nor a helper.} means, they will have no saviour to help them or rescue them from their predicament. Then Allah says: &!; sft uil j <rr-' 4On the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh, would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger."} means, they will be dragged into the Fire on their faces and their faces will be contorted in Hell, and in that state they will wish that they had been among those who had obeyed Allah and His Messenger jg in this world. Allah describes how they will be in the Hereafter: jAAj" £ ojji pjji! fjj} j 'laj .UI <il£=y JUu _^=*i)' (f. jjj jffi

iAnd the Day when the wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say: "Oh! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger. Ah! Woe to me! Would that I had never taken so- and-so as an intimate friend! He indeed led me astray from the Reminder after it had come to me. And Shaytān is to man ever a deserter in the hour of need."} (25:27-29) iX i 's_ Q>} iHow much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been Muslims.} (15:2) And here too, Allah tells us that when they are in this state, they will wish that they had obeyed Allah and His Messenger in this world: Ljuli Gill Cti Cl "Cj iAnd they will say: "Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the way."} Jawus said: " 'Our chiefs' means their nobles and 'our great ones' means their scholars." ^ ^!; Gj> iOur Lord! Give them double torment} means, "for their disbelief and because they mislead us." Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded from Abu Rafi' that among the names of those who fought with 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, was Al-Hajjaj bin 'Amr bin Ghaziyah, and he was the one who, when they met, said; "O people of the Ansar! Do you want to say when we meet our Lord: iOur Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the way. Our Lord! Give them double torment and curse them with a mighty curse!"} 4SI \L» lutf *1/0 i69. O you who believe! Be not like those who annoyed Musa,

but Allah cleared him of that which they alleged, and he was honorable before Allah. The Fabrications of the Jews against Musa Al-Bukhari recorded in the Book of Hadlths about the Prophets, that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ^ said: j* {£ji V f I j!B VI jidi\ li : I^Ui Jjl^! J>. Ji olST J* JliU Ij)v iL* ^ Sljt J*rj 3* <j!3 **' ^13 J u^'s. i'ib Uii t |*i _y«- bjj 'f^Jl *S& ^>*>J| v Iljj a l-lap Jl>*U 4jjij IJLP- I ofj i Iajs-lj AjUj ^l Jill *JrdLr-1 Of y J! ^ ^ C-T>^^ lAti t^Aii fu; ii« > «i jU u uu> :jl> jJI

tail jj 411I3* nUa»; ij\$*} 1 -IJj iyj£j y ljt»C ojiji fciUJLi - :JU - I— ->- _jt UJjt jl «4:f^ ii i* 36 !\$£ lie^
 ‘So <yy esc\$ iMusa, peace be upon him, was a shy and modest man who would never show anything of his skin because of his shyness. Some of the Children of Israel annoyed him by saying: “He only keeps himself covered because of some defect in his skin, either leprosy or scrotal hernia or some other defect.” Allah, may He be glorified, wanted to clear Musa, peace be upon him, of what they were saying. One day Musa was alone, so he took off his garment and put it on a rock, then he took a bath. When he had finished, he turned back to pick up his garment, but the rock moved away, taking his garment with it. Musa picked up his stick and chased the rock, saying, “My garment, O rock! My garment, O rock!” Until he reached a group of the Children of Israel, who saw him naked and found that he was the best of those whom Allah had created. Thus he was cleared of what they had said about him. Then the rock stood still, so he took his garment and put it on. He started hitting the rock with his stick, and by Allah, the marks of that beating were left

on the rock, three or four or five. This is what is referred to in the Ayah: {O you who believe! Be not like those who annoyed Musa, but Allah cleared him of that which they alleged, and he was honorable before Allah.} This Hadith is one of those which were recorded by Al-Bukhari but not Muslim. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah (bin Mas’ud) said: “One day, the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) distributed some booty and a man among the Ansar said, This division was not done for the sake of Allah.’ I said, ‘O enemy of Allah! I am going to tell the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) what you have said.’ So, I told the Prophet (ﷺ) about it. His face reddened and he said, (ﷺ) said, “May Allah have mercy on Musa. He was annoyed with worse than this, yet he remained patient.” This was recorded in the Two Sahih. 2. fa I Jic i and he was honorable before Allah. means, he had a position of status and honor before his Lord, may He be exalted and glorified. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: “His supplications would be answered by Allah.” 3. * Some of them said that part of his great standing before Allah was that he interceded for his brother Harun, asking Allah to send him with him as a Messenger, and Allah granted his request and said: 4. And We granted him his brother Harun, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy. (19:53) p pap ppp p gjj p \p: pi £>> /ifu) -i' pyj i70. O you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah and speak (always) the truth.} ** Fath Al-Bari 6:502. * Ahmad 1 :380, Al-Bukhari no. 3405, Muslim no. 1062. 131 Al-Baghawi 3 :545

53 Surah 33 . Al-Ahzab (70 - 73) (Part-22) 471. He will direct you to do righteous good deeds and will forgive you your sins. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed achieved a great victory.} The Command to the Believers to have Taqwa and speak the Truth Here Allah commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him, worshipping Him as if they can see Him, and to 4&xL ispeak (always) the truth.} meaning, to speak in a straightforward manner, with no crookedness or distortion. He promises them that if they do that, He will reward them by making their deeds righteous, i.e., enabling them to do righteous deeds, and He will forgive them their past sins. With regard to whatever sins they may commit in the future. He will inspire them to repent from them. Then He says: \jj Aii /Jyfa iuf g)<u J*j} 4. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed achieved a great victory.} meaning, he will be saved from the fire of Hell and will enjoy everlasting delights (in Paradise). if* iiUVt ce^j> && & 1^4 472. Truly, We did offer the Amanah to the heavens and the earth, and the mountains, but they declined to bear it and were afraid of it. But man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.} 473. So that Allah will punish the hypocrites, men and women, and the men and women who

are idolators. And Allah will pardon the believers, men and women . And Allah is Ever Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} m Amanah means trust. Here we see that there are reports that give particular explanations for it in this context.

HowMan bore theAmanah Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Al-Amdnah means obedience. This was offered to them before it was offered to Adam, and they could not bear it. Then Allah said to Adam: I have offered the Amanah to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, and they could not bear it. Will you take it on?’ He said, ‘O Lord, what does it involve?’ He said, If you do good, you will be rewarded, and ifyou do evil, you will be punished.’ So Adam took the Amanah and bore it, and this is what is referred to in the Ayah 4x4^- ‘Al iBut man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.}”Il] ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Al-Amdnah means Al-Fara’id (the obligatory duties). Allah offered them to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, (on the grounds that) if they fulfilled them, He would reward them; and if they failed, He would punish them. But they did not want to do that, and theywere afraid of it, not because their intentionwas sinful, but because oftheir respect for the religion ofAllah, in case they could not fulfill the obligations involved. Then Allah offered it to Adam, and he accepted it with all that it entailed. This is what is referred to in the Ayah: iBut man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.}’ meaning, he underestimated the command of Allah.”*2 This was also the view of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad- Dahhak, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others that Al-Amdnah means Al-Fara’id.. * Others said that it meant obedience. Al-A*mash narrated from Abu Ad-Duha from Masrttq that Ubayy bin Ka*b said: “Part of Al-Amdnah means that woman was entrusted with her own chastity. ”*4 ' Qatadah said: “Al-Amdnah means religion, obligatoiy duties and prescribed punishments. ”*5 111 At-Tabari 20:338. [2> At-Tabari 20:337. 131 At-Tabari 20:337. At-Tabari 20:338. At-Tabari 20:339.

Malik narrated that Zayd bin Aslam said: “Al-Amanah means three things: prayer, fasting and performing Ghusl to cleanse oneself from sexual impurity.” There is no contradiction between all of these views; they are all in agreement and all refer to responsibility and the acceptance of commands and prohibitions with their attendant conditions, which is that the one who fulfills this responsibility, will be rewarded; while the one who neglects it, will be punished. Man accepted this despite the fact that he is weak, ignorant and unjust - except for those whom Allah helps, and Allah is the One Whose help we seek. One of the reports which deal with Al-Amanah is the Hadlth recorded by Imam Ahmad from Hudhayfah, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: “The Messenger of Allah jg told us two Hadiths, one of which I have seen and the other 1 am still waiting to see. He told us that Al-Amanah is deeply rooted in the heart of man, then the Qur’an was revealed and they know it from the Qur’an and from the Sunnah. Then he told us that Al-Amanah will be taken away. He said, J^Jl } \ J4 \k')\ tJi jf l uVl tp ji^JI «A man may sleep and Al-Amanah will be taken from his heart, leaving nothing but a trace like a blister left by a coal if you were to roll it over your leg - you will see it protruding but there is nothing inside. » Then he tooka pebble and rolled itover his leg, then he said: •jtwj 3-? j Uj !3l1p 1j U dli i iThen the people will start buying and selling, and hardly anyone will be paying attention to Al-Amanah, until it will be said that among the tribe of so-and-so there is a trustworthy man, and it will said of a man, ‘how strong he is, how nice and how wise,’ and there is not even a mustard seed offaith in his heart. No doubt, there came upon me a time when I did not mind dealing (bargaining) with anyone of you, for if he was a Muslim, his Islam would compel him to pay me what is due to

and who obey Him. 4And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. This is end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ahzab. Allah's is the praise and thanks.

Surah 34: Saba

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4647–4652]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Saba' (Chapter - 34) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. the Most Merciful, the Oft-Forgiving.} All Praise and the Knowledge of the Unseen belong to Allah Alone Allah tells us that all praise belongs to Him alone in this world

meaning, He knows the number of raindrops that sink into the depths of the earth, and the seeds that have been sown, and the things that are hidden in it, and He knows what comes forth from that, how many they are, how they grow and what they look like. and that which descends from the heaven) means, of raindrops and provision, and what ascends into it, i.e., righteous deeds and other things. <iss> %) 4 And He is the Most Merciful, the Oft-Forgiving.) means, He is Most Merciful to His servants; He does not hasten to punish them, and He forgives the sins of those who repent to Him and put their trust in Him. jui. m V & ji ItA1 Jtij) ^4= 4 & 253 % j £ 4# t-ji; U\$ 'jiA <4/J '4,'^,* >fy I>i fri yC. iffrj <3. 77iose who disbelieve say: "The Hour will not come to us." Say: "Yes, by my Lord, the All-Knower of the Unseen, it will come to you; not even the weight of a speck of dust or less than that or greater escapes His knowledge in the heavens or in the earth but it is in a Clear Book.") i4. That He may recompense those who believe and do righteous good deeds. Tlwse, theirs is forgiveness and generous provision.) 45. But those who strive against Our Ayat to frustrate them - those, for them will be a severe painful torment.) 46. And those who have been given knowledge see that what is revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, and that it guides to the path of the Exalted in might, Owner of all praise.)

63 Surah 34. Saba (3 - 6) (Part-22) from Him." ' In other words, everything is encompassed by His knowledge, and nothing is hidden from Him. Even though bones may be scattered and disintegrate, He knows where they have gone and where they have dispersed, then He will bring them back just as He created them in the first place, because He has knowledge of all things. Then Allah tells us of His wisdom in re-creating bodies and bringing about the Hour, as He says: Z& Zg £ *41 \p: cJ i That He may recompense those who believe and do righteous good deeds. Those, theirs is forgiveness and generous provision. But those who strive against Our Ayat to frustrate them^ meaning, those who try to turn others away from the path of Allah and who disbelieve His Messengers, pj v>'j*4 pity i those, for them will be a severe painful torment.} This means, He will bestow His favor upon the blessed, who are the believers, and will punish the doomed, who are the disbelievers. This is like the Ayah: IifP) peA ZsfSS i Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful. (59:20) Ini ' 'Jp-j C/j)' s'f jT i Shall V\!e treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds like those who cause mischief on the earth? Or shall We treat those who have

Taqwd as the evildoers?} (38:28) ip\ A C*X -<Vll t-l }And those who have been given knowledge see that what is revealed to you from your Lord is the truth,} At-Tabari 20 :350

This is another kind of wisdom, following on from the one before, which is that when those who believed in what was revealed to the Messengers see the onset of the Hour and

how the righteous and the wicked will be rewarded and punished respectively, which they knew of beforehand in this world from the Books of Allah and which they are now seeing with their own eyes, they will say: i\$G& S3> ilndeed, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth} (7:43). And it will be said: i3jZf\$ 'J2j\ j£ u j •mm mmu Vi . -a JeAX.a)(tj X- ><%-' . * .tV f . *'^Z X JyvJ 'i3 Z*ul» ifi*L—A**<dOjLajo y ' £'C /S^> '>' *YC ^ >>/ IXyi^LJb ill 477ris is what the Most Gracious had promised, and the Messengers spoke truth!} (36:52| / »z*z <«/ Z W ' z, zz ,»» Z »z/. fj£ 'ji-4* oJj' >*J» ^ (j ^Lj -U)f> ilndeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until

the Day of Resurrection; so this is the Day of Resurrection}

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(30:56), 4,>? <il 3jG_> o*J' JI Gv ^ Kjif 'j3jl 4An<f those ivho have been given knowledge see that what is

revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, and that it guides to the path of the Exalted in might. Owner of all praise. The Exalted in might is the One Who is All-Powerful, Whom none can overwhelm or resist, but He subjugates and controls all things. The Owner of All praise is the One Who, in all His words, deeds, laws and decrees, is deserving of praise, may He be glorified and exalted. \$ 'Jiiy >jj ^ fa 'fSn j& uyft Jui li 4 'j0Tj ;as\^ (4^- £ t 4l !£ j3 4 <jl tli-lif h-4” ft?® kz -j jl o^” ^7 . Those who disbelieve say : “Shall we direct you to a man who will tell you (that) when you have become fully disintegrated into dust with fidl dispersion, then you will be created (again) aneiv?”4 48. Has he invented a lie against Allah, or is there a madness in him? Nay, but those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are (themselves) in a torment, and in far error. 49. See they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth? IfWe will, We shall sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the heaven to fall upon them. Verily, in this is a sign for every servant who turns (to Allah) in repentance. The Disbelievers’ Denial of Life after Death, and the Refutation ofTheirView Here Allah tells us how the disbelievers and heretics denied that the Hour will come, and mocked the Messenger jfc for speaking of it. 4Tlwse who disbelieve say : “Shall we direct you to a man who will tell you (that) when you have become fully disintegrated into dust with full dispersion ...?” means, when your bodies have disintegrated into the earth

66 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir and dispersed without a trace, iplt itthen you} means, after this has happened, }ivill be created (again) anew} means, you will be restored to life and will receive provision anew. “By telling us this, he is doing one of two things: either he is deliberately fabricating something and saying that Allah has revealed it to him, or he is not doing it deliberately, but he is deluded as crazy and insane people are.’ They said: 4 »' jil tijii }Has he invented a lie against Allah, or is there a madness in him?} Allah said, refuting their words: jiillJ yljji 4 'ofof, y pi j,} iNay, but those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are (themselves) in a torment, and in far error.} meaning, the matter is not as they claim or as

they think; on the contrary, Muhammad is the one who is telling the truth, and is righteous and wise; he is the one who has brought the truth, and they are the foolish and ignorant liars. iare themselves) in a tonnent,} means, their disbelief, which will lqad them to the torment of Allah. iatid in far error.} far from the truth in this world. Then Allah warns them of His power in the creation of heavens and earth, as He says: b *U'^ |T<&- Uj l* iiJJ li/ \$} }See they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth?} meaning, wherever they go, in whatever direction, the heavens

are above them and the earth is beneath them. This is like the Ayah iWith Hands did We construct the heaven. Verily, We are Able to extend the vastness of space thereof. And We have spread out the earth; how Excelletit Spreader (thereof) are We/^ (51:47-48) ilfWe will, We shall sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the heaven to fall upon them .)> means, 'if We wished, We could do that to them because- of their wrongdoing and Our power over them, but We delay it because We are Patient and Forgiving.' Then Allah says: jlj. ^Verily, in this is a sign for every Munib servant.} Ma'mar narrating from Qatadah, said that Al-Murub means every one who repents.! * Sufyan narrated from Qatadah, that Al-Murub is the one who turns to Allah.¹²¹ This means that in looking at the creation of the heavens and the earth, there is a sign for every servant who is intelligent and wise and who turns towards Allah. There is a sign of the Allah's ability to recreate bodies and bring about the Resurrection, because the One Who was able to create these heavens - with their vast reaches of space, and this earth, as deep and vast as it is - is able to recreate bodies and revive decayed bones. This is like the Ayat U J A 4< ils not He Who created the heavens and the earth. Able to create the like ofthem? Yes, indeed!} (36:81) y i&j cA ujuV'j c&LZSi 'Abdur-Razzaq 3:126. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 20 :356

68 Tafsfr Ibn Kafhir iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation ofmankind; yet, most ofmankind know not.} (40:57) J -kfJj A IjJ'j /L** y.2* iL Ijij ilil 4 .5',jw Lj ij[Udu» j jjij 410 . And indeed We bestowed grace on Dawud from Us (saying) : "O you mountains! Glorify with him! And you birds (also)! And We made the iron softfor him."} ill. Saying: "Make you perfect coats of mail, and balance well the rings of chain armor [Sard], and work you (men) righteousness. Truly, I am All-Seer ofwhat you do."} The Favors which Allah bestowed upon Dawud Here Allah tells us how He blessed His servant and Messenger Dawud (David), peace be upon him, and what He gave him of His great bounty, giving him both prophethood and kingship, and huge numbers of troops. And He blessed him with a mighty voice. Such that when he glorified Allah, the firm, solid, high mountains joined him in glorifying Allah, and the free-roaming birds, who go out in the morning and come back in the evening, stopped for him, and he was able to speak all languages. In the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah sH heard the voice of Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, reciting at night, and he stopped and listened to his recitation, then he said: "This man has been given one of the sweet melodious voices of the Prophet Dawud. Abu 'Uthman An-Nahdi said, "I never heard any cymbal, stringed instrument or chord that was more beautiful than the voice of Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him."¹²¹ 111 Muslim 1 :546. ¹²¹ Fadd'il Al-Qur'&n byAbu TJbayd p . 79

iGlorify} means, glorify Allah. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others. ' The root of this word [Ta'wib] means to repeat or respond, so the mountains and birds were commanded to repeat after him. iAnd Y<le made the iron soft for him.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, Al-A'mash and others said,

“He did not need to heat it in the fire or beat it with a hammer; he could simply twist it in his hands, like a thread.”² * Allah said: iSaying: "Make you perfect coats of mail..."}, which means chain mail. Qatadah said, “He was the first person ever to make chain mail; before that, they used to wear plated armor.”¹³¹ ip* j j£>} iand balance well the rings ofchain armor [Sard],} This is how Allah taught His Prophet Dawud, peace be upon him, to make coats of mail. Mujahid said concerning the Ayah: ip* j iand balance well the rings ofchain armor [Sard],} “Do not make the rivets too loose that the rings (of chain mail) will shake, or make them too tight that they will not be able to move at all, but make it just right.”⁴ ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that ‘Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Sard refers to a ring of iron.” Some of them said, “Chain mail is called Masrud if it is held together with rivets.” iPP \£%} iand work you (men) righteousness.} means, with regard to what At-Tabari 20:357. At-Tabari 20:359. 131 At-Tabari 20:359. |4! At-Tabari 20 :361

Allah has given you of blessings. ^Truly, I am All-Seer of what you do.} means, watching you and seeing all that you do and say; nothing of that is hidden at all. £ *0# St;J4 C& yf\ ^±jj} ILij C /J jJIm v'- ** o* (»r^^ oil* aJpJI ^ <JJSj Jjb JL, JJJjj *_>i\$£ fLrj JjLif C-J-* Cfi 4 l'rJfChi CtiU. 412. And to Sulayman (We subjected) the ivind, its morning ivas a month's (journey), and its afternoon was a month's (journey). And We caused a fount of Qitr to flow for him, and there were Jinn that worked in front of him, by the leave of his Lord. And whosoever ofthem turned asidefrom Our command, We shall cause him to taste of the torment of the blazing Fire.} 413. They workedfor him as he desired on Maliarib, Tamathil, large basins like Jawab and Qudiir Rasiyat. "Work you, O family of Dawud, with thanks!" But few ofMy servants are grateful.} The Favorswhich Allah bestowed upon Sulayman Having mentioned the blessings with which He favored Dawud, Allah follows this by mentioning what He gave to Dawud's son Sulayman (Solomon), may peace be upon them both. He subjugated the wind to him, so that it would cany his carpet one way for a month, then back again the next month. Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, “He set out from Damascus in the morning, landed in Istakhar where he ate a meal, then flew on from Istakhar and spent the night in Rahil.”¹¹¹ Between Damascus and Istakhar is an entire month's travel for a swift rider, and between Istakhar and Kabul is an entire month's travel for a swift rider. Jx. ^ (±^j} 4And We caused afount Qitr toflowfor him,} m At-Tabari 20 :362

Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be plased with him, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Malik from Zayd bin Aslam, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others said, “Qifr means copper.” ' Qatadah said, “It was in Yemen.”² Allah brought forth all the things that people make for Sulayman, peace be upon him. * ./\^ > '•' ' * yv ' iand there were Jinn that worked in front of him, by the leave ofhis Lord.} means, “We subjugated the Jinn to work in front of him,’ by the permission of his Lord, i.e., by Allah's decree and subjugation, they built whatever constructions he wanted, and did other work as well. iftp' of- 4And whosoever of them turned asidefrom Our command,} means, whoever among them tried to rebel and disobey, 4\Ne shall cause him to taste of the torment of the blazing Fire.} which means, burning. / / to £ JS ofe} 4They workedfor him as he desired on Maharib, Tamdthil,} Maharib refers to beautiful structures, the best and innermost part of a dwelling. Ibn Zayd said, “This means dwellings.”¹³ With regard to “Tamdthil,” ‘Atiyah Al-Awfi, Ad-Dahhak and As- Suddi said that Tamdthil means pictures.⁴ ' 4*4-6 j/Aj jLf,} 4large basins like Jawdb and Qudur Rasiyat.} Jawab, the plural form of Jabiyah, refers to cisterns or tanks ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 20:363, 364. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 20 :363 '3| At-Tabari 20:365. ,4' At-Tabari 20:366.

in which water is held, and Qudur Rasiyat are cauldrons that stay in one place and are not moved around because of their great size. This was the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others.¹¹¹ 4². jjo jv iEt> iWork you, Ofamily ofDaoud, with thanks!} means, We said to them: Work with thanks for the blessings that We have bestowed upon you in this world and the Hereafter.’ This indicates that thanks may be expressed by actions as much as by words and intentions. Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman Al-Hubuli said, “Prayer is thanks, fasting is thanks, every good deed that you do for the sake of Allah is thanks, and the best of thanks is praise.” This was recorded by Ibn Jarir. 121 In the Two Sahihs, it is reported that the Messenger of Allah jg said: nili ‘Jjbi > -• Z>\ 4il ^)J jin 41)1 JJ ^LjaJl Z.J-\ •JY Ijl % ij aThe most beloved of prayer to Allah is the prayer of Daoud. He used to sleep for half the night, stand in prayer for a third of it and sleep for a sixth of it. The most beloved of fasting to Allah is the fasting of Daoud. He used to fast for a day then notfastfor a day, and he never fled the battlefield .”¹²³ Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Fudayl said concerning the Ayah: i<p. IJC jil jEt> iWork you, Ofamily ofDaoud, ivith thanks!} Dawud said, “O Lord! How can I thank you when thanks itself is a blessing from You?” He said: “Now you have truly given thanks to Me, for you have realized that it is a blessing from Me.”⁴ > 1,1 At-Tabari 20:367. At-Tabari 20:369. Fath Al-Bari 6 :525 , Muslim 2 :816 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :680

iBut few of My servants are grateful.} This is a reflection of reality. J>- Di /oLlw ijib *fjy &p t» 0^*1' i^c. L .[via'i 4;;,^ ^31 4 £j CgX j jU v£ 414. Then when We decreed death for him, nothing informed them (Jinn) of his death except a little worm of the earth which kept (slowly) gnawing away at his stick. So when he fell down, the Jinn saw clearly that if they had known the Unseen, they would not have stayed in the humiliating torment.} The Death ofSulayman Allah tells us how Sulayman, peace be upon him, died and

how Allah concealed his death from the Jinn who were

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4661–4664]

subjugated to him to do hard labor. He remained leaning on his stick, which was his staff, as Ibn ‘Abbas may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others said. ’ He stayed like that for a long time, nearly a year. When a creature of the earth, which was a kind of worm, ate through the stick, it became weak and fell to the ground. Then it became apparent that he had died a long time before. It also became clear to Jinn and men alike that the Jinn do not know the Unseen as they (the Jinn) used to imagine and tried to deceive people. This is what Allah says: ,_AiJt 4 iyj L OfiLu inothing informed them (Jinn) of his death except a little worm of the earth which kept (slowly) gnawing away at his stick. So when he fell down, the Jinn saw clearly that if they had known the Unseen, they would not have stayed in the humiliating torment.} meaning, it became clear to the people that they (the Jinn) were lying. [i] At-Tabari 20 :370

His provision and give thanks to Him by worshipping Him alone, and they followed that for as long as Allah willed, then they turned away from that which they had been commanded to do. So they were punished with a flood which scattered them throughout the lands around Saba’ in all directions, as we will see in detail below, if Allah wills. In Him we put our trust. Ibn Jarir recorded that Farwah bin Musayk Al-Ghutayfi, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “A man said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Tell me about Saba’ - what was it, a land or a woman?’ He jg said: Ijiv1* ^ ‘sb** ^ ! I I L ij d)Ll-tj aL<1i’j !

ly**li; -,ij I UU • i Ij nit was neither a land nor a woman . It was a man who had ten children, six of whom went Yemen and four of whom went Ash-Sham. Those who went Ash-Sham were Lakhm, Judham, 'Amilah and Chassan. Those who went south were Kindah, Al- Ash'ariyyun, Al-Azd, Madhhij, Himyar and Anmdr .» A man asked, *Who are Anmar?' He 5g said: nThose among whom are Khath'am and Bajilahy This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi in his Jdmi' [Sunan] in more detail than this; then he said, "This is a Hasan Gharib Hadith.'™ The genealogists - including Muhammad bin Ishaq - said, "The name of Saba' was 'Abd Shams bin Yashjub bin Ya'rub bin Qahtan; he was called Saba' because he was the first Arab tribe to disperse. He was also known as Ar-Ra'ish, because he was the first one to take, booty in war and give it to his people, so he was called Ar-Ra'ish; because the Arabs call wealth Rtsh or Riyash. They differ over Qahtan, about whom there were three views. (The first) he descended from the line of Iram bin Sam bin 111 At-Tabari 20:375. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:88.

Nuh, then there were three different views over how he descended from him. (The second) was that he was descended from 'Abir, another name for Had, peace be upon him, then there were also three different views over exactly how he descended from him. (The third) was that he was descended from Ismail bin Ibrahim Al-Khalil, peace be upon him, then there were also three different views over exactly how he descended from him. This was discussed in full detail by Imam Al-Hafiz Abu Umar bin 'Abdul-Barr. An-Namari, may Allah have mercy on him, in his book Al-Musamma. Al-Inbah 'Ala. Dhikr Usui Al-Qaba'il Ar-Ruwat.

The meaning of the Prophet's words,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4664-4665]

JA dI£® He was a man among the Arabs.# means that he was one of the original Arabs, who were before Ibrahim, peace be upon him, and were descendants of Sam bin Nuh (Shem, the son of Noah). According to the third view mentioned above, he descended from Ibrahim, peace be upon him, but this was not a well-known view among them. And Allah knows best. But in Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is reported that the Messenger of Allah jg passed by a group of people from (the tribe of) Aslam who were practicing archery, and he said, <• 11.13^ H J- «Shoot, O sons of Isma'il, for your father was an archer. »'2' Aslam was a tribe of the Ansar, and the Ansar - both Aws and Khazraj - were from Ghassan, from the Arabs of Yemen from Saba', who settled in Yathrib when Saba' was scattered throughout the land when Allah sent against them the flood released from the dam. A group of them also settled in Syria, and they were called Ghassan for the name of the water beside which they camped - it was said that it was in the Yemen, or that it was near Al-Mushallal, as Hassan bin Thabit, may Allah be pleased with him, said in one of his poems. The meaning of his words: "If you ask, then we are the community of the noble descendants, our lineage is Al-Azd At-Tabari no. 28782. Fath Al-Bari 6 :261

and our water is Ghassan." «He /jfld fen sons among the Arabs. n' 1 ' means that these ten were of his lineage, and that the origins of the Arab tribes of the Yemen go back to him, not that they were his sons born of his loins. There may have been two or three generations between him and some of them, or more or less, as is explained in detail in the books of genealogy.

The meaning of the words,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4665]

\ • > * ' a I • » • 'Six ofwhom wait south andfour ofwhom went north . |a| is that after Allah sent against them the flood released from the dam, some of them stayed in their homeland, whilst others left to go elsewhere. TheDam ofMa'arib and the Flood

The story of the dam is about the water which used to come

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4665–4684]

to them from between two mountains, combined with the floods from rainfall and their valleys. Their ancient kings built a huge, strong dam and the water reached a high level between these two mountains. Then they planted trees and got the best fruits that could ever be harvested, plentiful and beautiful. A number of the Salaf, including Qatadah, mentioned that a woman could walk beneath the trees, carrying a basket or vessel - such as is used for gathering fruit - on her head. And that the fruit would fall from the trees and fill the basket without any need for her to make the effort to pick the fruit, because it was so plentiful and ripe.¹³ ' This was the dam of Ma'Hrib, a land between which and San'a' was a journey of three days. Others said that in their land there were no flies, mosquitoes or fleas, or any kind of vermin. This was because the weather was good and the people were healthy, and Allah took care of them so that they would single out and worship Him alone, as He says: At-Tabari no. 28782. AMabari no . 28782 131 At-Tabari 20:376.

^Indeed there was for Saha' (Sheba) a sign in their dwelling place} Then He explains this by saying: oi*; o* ob^*-^ 4two gardens on the right and on the left;} meaning, the two sides where the mountains were, and their land was in between them. ?£ tK 51#® 4(and it was said to them :) "Eat of the provision ofyour Lord, and be grateful to Him." A fair land and an Oft-Forgiving Lord!} means, 'He would forgive you if you continue to worship Him alone.' 4But they turned away,} means, from worshipping Allah alone and from giving thanks to Him for the blessings that He had bestowed upon them, and they started to worship the sun instead of Allah, as the hoopoe told Sulayman, peace be upon him: ;jr- at 4i pi (*-r »f-' OfJJ Oj-> <>* Lfj-U-j ^ ^ *> *2 4"I have come to you from Saba' (Sheba) with true news. I found a woman ruling over them, she has been given all things, and she has a great throne. I found her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has barred themfrom the way, so they have no guidance."} (27:22-24) iso We sent against them flood releasedfrom the dam,} Some, including Ibn 'Abbas, Wahb bin Munabbih, Qatadah

and Ad-Dahhak said that when Allah wanted to punish them by sending the flood upon them, he sent beasts from the earth to the dam, large rats, which made a hole in it. ' Wahb bin Munabbih said, "They found it written in their Scriptures that the dam would be destroyed because of these large rats. So they brought cats for a while, but when the decree came to pass, the rats overran the cats and went into the dam, making a hole in it, and it collapsed."² ' Qatadah and others said, "The large rat is the desert rat. They gnawed at the bottom of the dam until it became weak, then the time of the floods came and the waters hit the structure and it collapsed. The waters rushed through the bottom of the valley and destroyed everything in their path - buildings, trees, etc."³ As the water drained from the trees that

were on the mountains, to the right and the left, those trees dried up and were destroyed. Those beautiful, fruit-bearing trees were replaced with something altogether different, as Allah says: *scgi ^and We converted their two gardens into gardens producing bitter badfruit (ukul khamt),* Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ikiimah, ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi said, “It refers to Arak (Zingiber officinale) and bitter bad fruit.”¹⁴ iand Athl,} ‘Al-‘Awfi and Ibn ‘Abbas said that this means tamarisk. Others said that it means a tree that resembles a tamarisk, and it was said that it was the gum acacia or mimosa. And Allah knows best. iand somefew lote trees.} Because the lote trees were the best of the trees with which the garden was replaced, there were only a few ofthem. I1 ' At-Tabari 20:378, 380. 121 At-Tabari 20:381. 131 At-Tabari 20:381. (4) At-Tabari 20 : 382 , 383

80 Tafslr ton Kathir iand some few lote trees.\$ This is what happened to those two gardens after they had been so fruitful and productive, offering beautiful scenes, deep shade and flowing rivers: they were replaced with thorny trees, tamarisks and lote trees with huge thorns and little fruit. This was’because of their disbelief and their sin of associating others with Allah, and because they denied the truth and turned towards falsehood. Allah said: iLike this We requited them because they were ungrateful disbelievers. And never do We requite in such a way except those who are ungrateful. meaning, *We punished them for their disbelief.’ Mujahid said, “He does not punish anyone except the disbelievers.” Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “Allah the Almighty has spoken the truth: no one will be punished in a manner that befits the sin except the ungrateful disbelievers.” A i' • 4' S', "•iff *•++ V iaO ipse Sc/. ao p &sX&'Z 418. And We placed, between them and the towns which We had blessed, towns easy to be seen, and We made the stages (of journey) between them easy (saying) : “Travel in them safely both by night and day.”⁴ 419. But they said: "Our Lord! Make the stages between our journey longer," and they wronged themselves; so We made than as tales (in the land), and We dispersed them all totally. Verily, in this are indeed signs for every steadfast, grateful (person).} The Trade of Saba* and Their Destruction Allah tells us about the blessings which the people of Saba’ enjoyed, and the luxuries and plentiful provision which was m Al-Baghawi 3:555.

theirs in their land, with its secure dwellings and towns which were joined to one another, with many trees, crops and fruits. When they traveled, they had no need to carry provisions or water with them; wherever they stopped, they would find water and fruits, so they could take their noontime rest in one town, and stay overnight in another, according to their needs on their journey. Allah says: iAnd We placed, between them and the towns which We had blessed,\$ Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Said bin Jubayr and Malik, who narrated it from Zayd bin Aslam, and Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Ibn Zayd and others - all said that this means the towns of Syria. It means they used to travel from Yemen to Syria via towns easy to be seen and connected to one another.¹¹¹ Al- ‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The towns which We had blessed by putting Jerusalem among them.”^{*2} ' itowns easy to be seen,} meaning, clear and visible, known to travelers, so they could take their noontime rest in one town and stay overnight in another. Allah says: iand We made the stages (ofjourney) between them easy} meaning, *We made it in a way that met the needs of the travelers.’ i'a^C Ctij 30£ ICi-.} 4Travel in them safely both by night and day.} means, those who travel in them will be safe both by night and by day. \pSf, iLiijE^% \)& iBut they said: "Our Lord! Make the stages between our journey longer," and they wronged themselves;} At-Tabari 20:386, 387. At-Tabari 20:386.

83Sarah 34. Saba (20 - 21) (Part-22) Laylah,*** There is a corroborating report in the Two Sahihs, where a Hadith narrated by Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, says: *pd jj id Ij-a- VI tiju <i <U ^Jia i V VI JpV Jjji plj Ip p tip. oUaf *<Jp ii& «How amazing is the affair of the believer! Allah does not decree anything for him blit it is good for him. If something good happens to him, he gives thanks, and that is good far him; if something bad happens to him, he bears it with patience, and that is good far him. This is not far anyone except the believeryW It was reported that Qatadah said: p,pv^ 4 iVerily, in this are indeed signs far every steadfast, grateful.} It was Mutarrif who used to say: “How blessed is the grateful, patient servant. If he is given something, he gives thanks, and if he is tested, he bears it with patience.”*3 *^ yd ti^i A p—jli yji pU pL jJLi xi\j} ^ ^ pi A « 420. And indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them, and theyfallowed him, all except a group of true believers.} 422. And he had no authority over them, - except that We might test him who believes in the Hereafter, from him who is in doubt about it. And your Lord is Watchful over everything.} How Iblis' thought about the DisbelieverprovedTrue Having mentioned Saba' and how they followed their desires, and the Shaytan, Allah tells us about their counterparts *** An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6 :263 121 Fath Al-Bari 10:107. * Muslim 4:1992.*

among those who follow Iblls and their own desires, and who go against wisdom and true guidance. Allah says: jli j%) 4And indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them,) Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others’ said that this Ayah is like the Ayah where Allah tells us about how Iblis refused to prostrate to Adam, peace be upon him, then said: 4*^4' jy. ciiA ojJ '& jii lift 4See this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite to the Day of Resurrection, I will surely seize and mislead his offspring all but afew!) (17:62) ^ rrr^' ry*' & < jr) 4Then I will come to them from before than and behind them, from their right andfrom their left, and You will not find most of than as thankful ones.) (7:17) And there are many Ayat which refer to this matter. Jt |*^lc /J 0^=» 4And he (Iblis) had no authority over than,) Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said, “This means, he had no proof.” ^ J* O+t j &j> cy (^*4 4except that We might test him wlv believes in the Hereafter, from him who is in doubt about it.) means, “We gave him power over them only to show who believes in the Hereafter and that it will come to pass.’ The people will be brought to account and rewarded or punished accordingly, so that he will worship his Lord properly in this world - and to distinguish these believers from those who are in doubt about the Hereafter. At-Tabari 20 :392

tCA <X& 4And your Lord is a Watchful over everything.} means, despite His watching, those who follow Iblis go astray, but by His watching and care, the believers who follow the Messengers are saved. oj» oj fAj i jj'i JliEj oy&t!Uj y 4ill ii fc \$ % ^^ y; ^ & 'a Ia jli 'it. ijlli j-Vj* j •pi jij tfu if:#' ill. Say: "Call upon tlwse whom you assert besides Allah, they possess not even the weight ofa speck of dust, either in the heavens or on the earth, nor have they any share in either, nor there is for Him any supporterfrom among them."} }23 . Intercession with Him profits not exceptfor him whom He permits. So much so that when fear is banished from their hearts, they say: "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} The Helplessness ofthe gods ofthe Idolators Here Allah states clearly that He is the One and Only God, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who has no peer or partner; He is independent in His command and there is no one who can

4^1 jili cJ Jju V *i^y* rJ^ ^ \$f} 4\$'Sfc5 4And ftere are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave Jbr whom He wills and is pleased with.} (53:26) y/ > . a (**j p. iand they cannot intercede except Jbr him with whom He is pleased. And they stand in aweJbrfear ofHim} (21:28). It was reported in the Two Sahihs through more than one chain of narration that the Messenger of Allah who is the leader of the sons ofAdam and the greatest intercessor before Allah, will go to stand in Al-Maqam Al-Mahmud (the praised position) to intercede for all of mankind when their Lord comes to pass judgement upon them. He said: V <I)i l» (jif-Jj PUi 4U *£jLU £jJ.\ kLJo (j-j' t j Jiilj ^ijl : JllJ ii)VI "Then I will prostrate to Allah, may He be exalted, and He will leave me (in that position), as long as Allah wills, and He will inspire me to speak words of praise which I cannot mention now. Then it will be said, "O Muhammad, raise your head. Speak, you will be heard; ask, you will be given; intercede, your intercession will be accepted..."»(1 ' &Ji !#pj ISC U>jjP gi ui&} iSo much so that when fear is banishedfrom their hearts, they say: "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth.} This also refers to the great degree of His might and power. When He speaks words of revelation, the inhabitants of the heavens hear what He says, and they tremble with fear (ofAllah) so much that they swoon. This was the view ofIbn Mas"rid, may Allah be pleased with him, Masruq and others.12' Fath Al-Bari 8 :248 , Muslim 1 :185 Al-Tabari 20:396.

88 Tafstr Ibn Kathir / m .w / />> / J/ V u* ' ^1 &•} iSo much so that when fear is banishedfrom their hearts,} means, when the fear leaves their hearts. Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Umar, Abu 'Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Ash-Sha'bi, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i, Ad-Dhahhak, Al-Hasan and Qatadah said concerning the Ayah, ^ ^£g 4 4So much so that when fear is banishedfrom their hearts, they say: "Wltat is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth.} "When the fear is lifted from their hearts." When this happens, some of them say to others, "What did your Lord say?" Those (angels) who are carrying the Throne tell those who are next to them, then they in turn pass it on to those who are next to them, and so on, until the news reaches the inhabitants of the lowest heaven. Allah says, iThey say the truth.} meaning, they report what He said, without adding or taking away anything. if -p' 4And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} In his Tafstr of this Ayah in his Sahth, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him said, "The Prophet of Allah^ said: i^JP I Pljo <ujI lip Ij} \j JI» liU : I IA £> 'ip {JZ-aJLJL l l tjj * i^_S3l ,L«J I ceP^I : Jli i ^49 eJui jllLl JJ " ijji kJuu j* Jj~ iiiii: If Jj liLJj^ 14-ab ilKJI it Jj uuit u!jj 4 i£ik it jj 4,14131 Jsp u# 4^isJi jt ^tui

"When Allah decrees a matter in heaven, the angels beat their xvings in submission to His Words, making a sound like a chain striking a smooth rock. When the fear is banished from their hearts, they say, "Wlmt is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth, and He is the Most High, the Most Great. Then the one who is listening out hears that, and those who are listening out are standing one above the other» - Sufyan [one of the narrators] demonstrated with his hand, holding it vertically with the fingers outspread. «So he hears what is said and passes it on to the one below him, and that one passes it to the one ivho is beloiv him, and so on until it reaches the lips of the soothsayer or fortune-teller. Maybe a meteor will hit him before he can pass anything on, or maybe he will pass it on before he is hit. He tells a hundred lies alongside it, but it toill be said, "Did he not tell us that on such and such a day, such and such would happen?" So they believe him because of the one thing which zuas heardfrom heavenj" This was recorded by Al-Bukhari, not by Muslim. Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah also recorded it. And Allah knows best. 4 £3 jl ^ "if J5 £-4 J . * lie jlij 'ij Ki/j lie V Ji ! n'oAji jiL» *1 't* Ipj

1 ji jij lli. ^CJu £ Uj jjjr if 424. Say: "Who gives you provision from the heavens and the earth?" Say: "Allah. And verily, (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error."} 425. Say : "You will not be asked about our sins, nor shall we be asked of what you do."} 426. Say: "Our Lord will assemble us all together, then He will judge between us with truth . And He is the Just Judge, the All-Knower of the true state of affairs."} 427. Say: "Show me those whom you have joined with Him as 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :398 * Abu Dawud 4 :288, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :90, Ibn Majah 1 :69.

90 Tafstr Ibn KathTr partners. Nay! But He is Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise."} Allah has no partner in anything whatsoever Allah tells us that He is unique in His power of creation and His giving of provision, and that He is unique in His divinity also. As they used to admit that no one in heaven or on earth except Allah gave them provision, i.e., by sending down water and causing crops to grow, so they should also realize that there is no god worthy of worship besides Him. iAnd verily, (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error.} 'One of the two sides must be speaking falsehood, and one must be telling the truth. There is no way that you and we could both be following true guidance, or could both be misguided. Only one of us can be correct, and we have produced the proof of Tawhid which indicates that your Shirk must be false.' Allah says: ^ j' tyj} iAnd verily, (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error.} Qatadah said, "The Companions of Muhammad jg said this to the idolators: "By Allah, we and you cannot be following the same thing, only one of us can be truly guided."" 'Ikrimah and Ziyad bin Abi Maryam said, "It means: we are rightly guided and you are in plain error."*21 iSay : "You will not be asked about our sins, nor shall we be asked of what you do."} This indicates disowning them, saying, "you do not belong to us and we do not belong to you, because we call people to Allah, to believe that He is the Only God and to worship Him alone. If you respond, then you will belong to us and we to 111 At-Tabari 20:401. 121 At-Tabari 20:401.

you, but if you reject our call, then we have nothing to do with you and you have nothing to do with us.' This is like the Ayat 14 %& % Sj% iil fiz p; 4 jg iijir 4And // they deny you, say: "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!"} (10:41) iyj\$ Z Sjrit .3 Vj 1TJ^jLt 6 iic <(Say; "O disbelievers! I worship not that which you worship, Nor will you worship that which I worship. And I shall not worship that which you are worshipping. Nor will you worship that which I worship. To you be your religion, and to me my religion."} (104:1-6). iSay: "Our Lord will assemble us all together..."} means, 'on the Day of Resurrection, He will bring all of creation together in one arena, then He will judge between us with truth, i.e., with justice.' Each person will be rewarded or punished according to his deeds; if they are good, then his end will be good, and if they are bad, then his end will be bad. On that Day they will know who has attained victory, glory and eternal happiness, as Allah says: j Z4J ijUis-j i^l. 'fyj} tfUJj i \j& Ifjii UjJ lr~ iAnd on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated. Then as far those who believed and did righteous good deeds, such shall be honored and made to enjoy luxurious life (forever) in a Garden of Delight. And as far those who disbelieved and denied Our Ayat, and the meeting of the Hereafter, such shall be brought forth to the torment.} (30:14-16).

Allah says: V& tr3' -&> iAnd He is the Just Judge, the All-Knower of the true state of affairs .} iSay: "Show me those whom you have joined with Him as partners..."} means, 'show me those gods whom you made as rivals and equals to Allah.' t 0} }Nay} means, He has no peer, rival, partner or equal. Allah

says: \$But He is Allah,} meaning, the One and Only God Who has no partner. ithe Almighty, the All-Wise.} means, the Owner of might with which He subjugates and controls all things, the One Who is Wise in all His Words and deeds. Laws and decrees. Blessed and exalted and sanctified be He far above all that they say. And Allah knows best. f o;0' Jk=^ \ {t*41 o-M. <A±&) tj} ait V fy_ iCS, > .:£=-> o[428. And We have not sent you except as a giver of glad tidings and a wamer to all mankind, and most of men know not.} 429 . And they say: "When is this promise if you are truthful?"} 430 . Say: "The appointment to you is for a Day, which you cannot put backfor an hour nor putforward."} The Prophet \$gg was sent to all ofMankind Allah says to His servant and Messenger Muhammad s=\$: 4**i4> UA. ofA <=&=> vj S tj}

4And We have not sent you except as a giver of glad tidings and a wamer to all mankind, i.e., to all of creation among those who are accountable for their deeds. This is like the Ayah 4^ ii; ji» 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah."} (7:158) i&i \$> j> 4' iBlessed be He Who sent down the Criterion to His servant that he may be a wamer to the all creatures.} (25:1) 4a giver of glad tidings and a wamer} means, "to bring the glad tidings of Paradise to those who obey you and to warn of the fire of Hell to those who disobey you.' This is like the Ayat 4and most ofmen know not.} 4 -'if. 3b Z'f} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) 4<i>3^ 44 cr \$ j£} 4And ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead youfar awayfrom Allah's path} (6:1 16). Muhammad bin Ka*b said concerning the Ayah: 4oM iSSbm Zj} 4And We have not sent you except to all mankind} meaning, to all the people. Qatadah said concerning this Ayah, "Allah, may He be exalted, sent Muhammad jg to both the Arabs and the non-Arabs, so the most honored of them with Allah is the one who is most obedient to Allah." m At-Tabari 20:405.

95Surah 34. Saba (28 - 30) (Part-22) Jj trr mump %, / ^ #*5 ^ ^ * / • / (v- kJy%j*r_>^~^ <3? „ s< •* ^ . '>>V' - »/ * l/VO .•/• i I t » t 5j(JJ l 3? cgjjj £t2ii!£\$M ,1)jiiijiiJsflcJ'G^b -^/- • . 'rx'^AT''''^s» ^ ''''•* t' JLL-jiUj^ o^L^»ylSl* a^O^~^Jjb <jrwLw IjjScJjJjaij «.L7J(j-J '_k_jj(Jjjjji j oi^:v ^ (>*t> 5#^3*2vCttf, r" ,/ * £>* ' ' > ' . :-,r-7 >~* -•'<, <4s» . ' .\{>»/:'> ' > , -j - >;< IJAJ Jiy'_>0-jA_)^*^Jd#£ Allah says: iThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and kttoiv that it is the very truth...} (42:18) Then Allah says: M X* & & &C Z * > •"•" iSay : "The appointment to you is for a Day, ivhiclt you cannot for an hour move back nor forward."} meaning, 'you have an appointed time which is fixed and cannot be changed or altered. When it comes, you will not be able to put it back or bring it forward,' as li iVerily, the term of Allah when it comes, cannot be delayed} (71:4). •>i% "i ot fj, jf.ijiSZ J~X 'Jj }And We delay it only Jbr a term (already) fixed. On the Day when it comes, no person slwll speak except by His leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.} (11:104- 105).

jjy-;^1--1 Jy-i « <^ •: q/ x~Ji uk %&.' 1\$ jti &5 ft % \ZS& vA ijjiij \y* . 'n' .1 JIS) J? SA*r ^ -*j*> <y ! &S Kul /i j^J ii ^2 Ji b£l ii ^ i]£&3 kk ^ j£V< iii^~j 4ask ft ' L'CSif 4^ 4A-e 432. And t/iose who disbelieve say: "We believe not in this Qur'an nor in that which ivas before it." But if you could see when the wrongdoers are wade to stand before their Lord, how they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!"} 432. And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you backfrom guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were

criminals."} 433. Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, what they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?}

How the Disbelievers have agreed in this World to deny

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4684–4697]

the Truth, and how They will dispute with One Another on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about the excessive wrongdoing and stubbornness of the disbelievers, and their insistence on not believing in the Holy Qur'an and what it tells them about the Resurrection. Allah says: 4*Jj *>. Vj J lifoS' jlij4 4And those who disbelieve say: "We believe not in this Qur'an nor in that which was before it."} Allah threatens them and warns them of the humiliating

97Surah 34. Saba (31 - 33) (Part-22) position they will be in before Him, arguing and disputing with one another: Jy-> Jjii' 4hmv they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak} this refers to the followers - 4to those who were arrogant} - this refers to the leaders and masters - 44s£&^ 4Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!} meaning, 'if you had not stopped us, we would have followed the Messengers and believed in what they brought.' Their leaders and masters, those who were arrogant, will say to them: i; j. &} 4Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you?} meaning, "we did nothing more to you than to call you, and you followed us without any evidence or proof, and you went against the evidence and proof which the Messengers brought because of your own desires; it was your own choice." They will say: ^ S. jjL^Lir Sfif jijj '.fi ^ 4"...Nay, but you were criminals." Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day..."} meaning, "you used to plot against us night and day, tempting us with promises and false hopes, and telling us that we were truly guided and that we were following something, but all of that was falsehood and manifest lies." Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said:

4Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, means, "You plotted by night and day.",¹ Malik narrated something similar from Zayd bin Aslam.¹² iY/J a ^ iwhen you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!} means, to set up gods as equal to Him, and you created doubts and confusion in our minds, and you fabricated far-fetched ideas with which to lead us astray.' 4And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, when they behold the torment.} means, both the leaders and the followers will feel regret for what they did previously. 4}if& cjif -j jiS/i [&rj} 4And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved.} This is a chain which will tie their hands to their necks. ix£ -n&& &} 4Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} means, they will be punished according to their deeds: the leaders will be punished according to what they did, and the followers will be punished according to what they did. 4X& 4He will say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you know not."} (7:38). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: ip* ", ' - j*Jl At-Tabari 20:408. 121 At-Tabari 20:408.

uWhen the people of Hell are driven towards it, it will meet them with its flames, then the Fire will bum theirfaces and the flesh will all fall to their hamstrings .n”* 11 jllij jS ‘if IfijitA’ Jli frlr* ^ jjij illJ JJ ilf; djJ i>I j* Cj ‘oJlJl) _A^=>’ £ 4lM £* ‘8? Jv £\$ vj^ Uj :*;££: v^ &U •>¥?-. (»-*> l*» > ilvil’ ‘fr ijliJjii UX»o J— <>•! ^1 ** fIf ^ >*” - , •! >*”•> • <-‘1*1 *’• S. ‘S . ***’ O+i 133/’ »<>» tl)^ .yT^vilL^/va^ <_ \$ o>*— /> / > .•> ->< . >v:.t t^ y’ * .*/ X jy ’ /A»-^s j4* of ->~4Aj ’ vj fi **£’-?£ o^ *W 434. And We did not send a wamer to a toivnship but those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among than said: "We believe not in what you have been salt with."} 435. And they say : "We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished."} 436. Say: "Verily , my Lord expands the provision to whom He wills and restricts, but most men know not.”} 437. And it is not your wealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us, but only he who believes, and does righteous deeds; as for such, there will be multiple rewards for what they did, and they will reside in the high dwellings (Paradise) in peace and security.} 435. And those who strive against Our Ayat, to frustrate them, they will be brought to the torment.} 439. Say: "Truly, my Lord expands the provision for whom He wills of His servants, and (also) restricts (it) for him, and whatsoever you spend of anything, He will replace it. And He is the Best ofproviders."} HowThoseWho lived a Life ofLuxury disbelieved in the Messengers and were misledby Their pursuit ofWealth and Children Allah is consoling His Prophet jg and commanding him to I 1 * Hilyat Al-Awliya’ 4:363, where Abu Nu’aym indicates that it is probably Mawquf.

200 Tafslr Ibn Kathir follow the example of the Messengers that came before him. He tells him that no Prophet was ever sent to a township but those among its people who lived a life of luxury disbelieved in him, and the weaker people of the town followed him. The people of Nuh, peace be upon him, said to him: /< if ‘ « p»» V ^ cef} iShall we believe in you, when the weakest (of the people) follow you?} (26:110) 4nor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking} (1 1:27). The leaders among the people of Salih said: q Qg Iff Js i fa itk 4to those who were counted weak - to such ofthem as believed "Know you that Salili is one sent from his Lord." They said : "We indeed believe in that with which he has been sent." Those who were arrogant said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that which you believe in."} (7:75-76). And Allah said: 'if is ^ 'if i&a £5 diUk^j} iThus We have tried some of them with others, that they might say: "Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from among us?" Does not Allah know best those who are gratefil?} (6:53), 4^+r* iir^=£. fr 4 ii&^j} 4And thus We have set up in every town great ones of its wicked people to plot therein} (6:123), and t>-j IfJ J liijl ljl£ <(And when We decide to destroy a town (population), We (first) send a definite order to those among them who lead a life

of luxury. Then, they transgress therein, and thus the Word (of torment) is justified against it (them). Then We destroy it with complete destruction} (17:16). And Allah says here: 4.J& Crt Mr* 4^^ iAnd We did not send a wamer to a township} meaning a Prophet or a Messenger, /- / ><***> /<* 4 \ Jtt^ ibut those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among them} means, those who enjoyed a life of riches and luxury, and positions of leadership. Qatadah said, “They are their tyrants, chiefs and leaders in evil.” -if iL &{} iWe believe not in the (Message) with which you have been sent.} means, “we do not believe in it and we will not follow it.’ Allah tells us that those who enjoyed a life of luxury and who disbelieved the Messengers said: iAnd they say: "We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished."} meaning, they were proud of their great wealth and great numbers of

children, and they believed that this was a sign that Allah loved them and cared for them, and that if He gave them this in this world, He would not punish them in the Hereafter. This was too far-fetched. Allah says: \ / c r'vff . A * w y.*"< iDo they think that in wealth and children with which We enlarge them? We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but Urey perceive not.} (23:55-56) [i] At-Tabari 20 :409

dr“JJ CjJI si-**1' 4 'rj ^ -V/ Q Vj 'P'P &>JL^ 4So, let not their wealth nor their children amaze you ; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart while they are disbelievers.} (9:55), and A •“n- jvj VU /<! oili- yj iLeave Me Alone (to deal with whom 1 created lonely. And then granted him resources in abundance. And children to be by his side. And made life smooth and comfortable for him. After all that he desires that I should give more. Nay! Verily, he has been opposing Our Aydt. I shall oblige him to face a severe torment!} (74:11-17) And Allah has told us about the story of the owner of those two gardens, that he had wealth and crops and children, but that could not help him at all when all of that was taken from him in this world, before he reached the Hereafter. Allah says here: 4 -kLy. 4j 5) iSay: “Verily , my Lord expands the provision to whom He wills and restricts...”} meaning, He gives wealth to those whom He loves and those whom He does not love, and He makes poor whom He wills and makes rich whom He wills. He has complete wisdom and clear proof, 1 jS\ &} ibut most men know not.} Then Allah says: iAnd it is not your xoealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us,} meaning, ‘these things are not a sign that We love you or care

for you.’ Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah sg said: Ji ’j)& di jfij Ji ’j& i JuS ai h\> "Allah does not look at your outward appearance or your wealth, rather He looks at your hearts and your deeds . »• 11 Muslim and Ibn Majah also recorded thisJ2 ' Allah says: ibut only he who believes, and does righteous deeds;} meaning, ‘only faith and righteous deeds will bringyou closer to Us.’ ill > imjji 'p* tiUpfi} iasfor such, there will be multiple rewardsfor what they did,} means, the reward will be multiplied for them between ten and seven hundred times. }and they will reside in the high dwellings in peace and security .} means, in the lofty dwellings of Paradise, safe from all misery, fear and harm, and from any evil they could fear. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: __ ^ ^ > > y ^ t t _ > ^ " ^ " J* ^ • «/n Paradise there are lofty rooms whose outside can be seen from the inside and whose inside can be seenfrom the outside." A bedouin asked, “Who are they for?” He^ said: «For those who speak well, feed the hungry, persist in fasting and pray at night while people are asleepV3 ' Ahmad 2:539. ^ Muslim 4 :1987 , Ibn Majah 2 :1388 131 Ibn Abi Shaybah 8 :437.

104 Tafslr Ibn Kathir &i"* c5 ojZi iAnd those who strive against Our Ayat, to frustrate them,} means, those who try to block people from the path of Allah and from following His Messengers and believing in His signs, ithey will be brought to the torment.} means, they will all be punished for their deeds, each one accordingly. \$ cx 52 ill X>k iSay: “Truly, my Lord expands the provision for whom He wills ofHis servants, and (also) restricts (it)for him...”} means, according to His wisdom, He gives a lot of provision to one, and gives very little to another. He has great wisdom in doing so, which cannot be comprehended by anyone but Him. This is like the Ayah iSee how Wefavor one above another, and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater infavor.} (17:21). This means that just as

there are differences between them in this world - where one may be poor and in straitened circumstances while another is rich and enjoys a life of plenty - so they will be in the Hereafter. There one will reside in apartments in the highest levels of Paradise, whilst another will be in the lowest levels of Hell. As the Prophet [^] said, describing the best of people in this world: «»W Lii <il j UU5 3jjj pt-.l 4 “He truly succeeds who becomes Muslim and is given just enough provision and Allah makes him content with what He has given . It was recorded by Muslim. Zj} iand whatsoever you spend of anything. He will replace it.} m Muslim 2 :730.

Surah 34, Saba (40 - 42) (Part-22) trr r. > •>>>- # i/ »y / *> A>» »*' •/' >> £5^»J) ij^i^oySIJSjciAi^ciUjV j\ >.'?' . >?~',,'Z" ? t# vMlTV *,*» -M" 1JA7 }'AJbO;|V* *-w^ ^~.,jT' r' ' .1? \$J&'i&sk V ,/ /f >^, /'''/^ > ^^> ^ / "*" ' { > “t- j^..n^1'^ (,4 1 j J.^ S>Vj J,V0^14 >«*a /lt\l.^ *j2j mmmx,means, ‘whatever you spend in the ways that He has commanded you and permitted you, He will compensate you for it in this world by giving you something else instead, and in the Hereafter by giving you reward.’ It was reported that the Prophet said: I i_jjjuij -Uj-i}A «i)l (J^b® «itif- «A//a/i says: "Spend, 1 will spend on you."® In another Hadlth it is reported that every morning, two angels come, and one says, “O Allah, bring destruction upon the one who withholds (does not spend).” The other one says, “O Allah, give compensation to the one who spends.” And the Messenger of Allah jg said: W*i) ^>]|&^>L Vj cJ% jiib «Spend, O Bilal, and do not fear that the One Who is on the Throne will withlwdfrom you.i*2 A Ju^i \)£ \}Z=»% \$£\ JIU; 'J fjlli j^r Cifx.u jylT j? LJ> 4 1 IVj>-^2 jA jlf jDl vUc jijij ojjjl Jyuj I fjA (1 * Muslim 1 :700. *21 At-Tabarani 10:191.

440. And (remember) the Day when He will gather them all together, then He will say to the angels : “Was it you that these people used to worship?”} 441 . They (the angels) will say : "Glorified be You! You are our Protector instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most ofthem were believers in them."} 442. So Today, none of you can profit or harm one another. And We shall say to those who did wrong : "Taste the torment of the Fire which you used to deny."} TheAngels willdisown TheirWorshippers on theDay of Resurrection Allah tells us that on the Day of Resurrection, He will rebuke the idolators before all of creation. He will ask the angels whom the idolators used to worship, claiming that their idols were in the form of these angels and that they could bring them nearer to Allah. He will ask the angels: s*.%mi it you that these people used to worship?} meaning, ‘did you command them to worship you?’ Allah says in Surat Al-Furqarc 4Was it you who misled these My servants or did they (themselves) strayfrom the (right) path?} (25:17). And He will say to Isa, peace be upon him: Jji) J OjKj UA.**. /. Jta jjj J* (j\ djjicf 'Jjliu ci» d*} 4Did you say unto men : "Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?,' He will say: "Glory be to You! It was not for me to say what I had no right (to say)."} (5:116). Similarly, the angels will say: 4Glorified be You!} meaning, ‘exalted and sanctified be You above the notion that there could be any god besides You.’

4You are our Protector instead of them.) means, *we are Your servants and we disown these people before You.’ J>) 4Nay, but they used to worship the jinn;) meaning, the Shayatin, because they are the ones who made idol worship attractive to them and who misguided them. imost ofthem were believers in them This is like the Ayah: iThey invoke nothing but females besides Him, and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel! Allah cursed him (4:117-118). Allah says: Y*& Y {\$) 4So Today, none ofyou can profit or harm one another. means, ‘none of those idols and rivals whom you hoped would

benefit you, will be of any avail to you, those whom you worshipped in the hope that they would help you at times of stress and calamity. Today they will have no power either to benefit you or to harm you.' ah &*>) 4And We shall say to those who did wrong:) - meaning the idolaters - jiif i 4"Taste the torment of the Fire which you used to deny.") meaning, this will be said to them by way of rebuke. Y't Til c |# &:\$\$ %)

209Surah 34. Saba (43 - 45) fPart-22) meaning, Allah did not reveal any Book to the Arabs before the Qur'an, and He did not send any Prophet to them before Muhammad £6. They used to wish for that and say, 'if only a wamer comes to us or a Book is revealed to us, we would be more guided than others,' but when Allah blessed them with that, they disbelieved him and stubbornly rejected him. Then Allah says: i'ri& oj ccjfr iAtid those before them denied;} meaning, other nations. "C iyi Cj} it hese have not received even a tenth of what We had granted to those (ofold);} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Of the power of this world."111 This was also the view of Qatadah, As- Suddi and Ibn Zayd. ,2) This is like the Ayat. U (*t: 6Uj a!' 01AS oj-wJc. 'jit'" ^ 'ij (4Jb- isr indeed We had firmly established them with that wherewith We have not established you! And We had assigned than the hearing, seeing, and hearts; but their hearing, seeing, and their hearts availed than nothing since they used to deny the Ayat of Allah, and they were completely encircled by that which they used to mock at!) (46:26) fa HjS ot iHave they not traveled through the earth and seal what was

the end of those before than? They were more in number than

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4697–4701]

them and mightier in strength} (40:82). but that did not protect them from the punishment of Allah, 111 At-Jabari 20:416. 121 At-Tabari 20:416, 417.

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir and Allah destroyed them because they denied His Messengers. Allah says: iyet they denied My Messengers. Then how (terrible) was My denial!} meaning, 'how severe was My wrath and how great was My avenging of My Messengers.' & [£kscei • i'SKf-t) (|s- y^ 'i-i <|£ (^3 jj? VJ <46. Say: '7 exhort you to one (thing) only, that you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion . He is only a wamer to you in face of a severe torment."} Refutation of Their Accusation that the Prophet§ was Insane Allah says: 'Say, O Muhammad, to these disbelievers who claim that you are crazy,' 4pL*}j q> 4/ exhort you to one (thing) only,} meaning, 1 am only telling you to one thing,' and that is: 4that you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion.} meaning, 'stand sincerely before Allah, without being influenced by your own desires or tribal feelings, and ask one another, is Muhammad crazy? Advise one another,' iand reflect} means, let each person look within himself concerning the matter of Muhammad ig, and ask other people about him if he is still confused, then let him think about the matter. Allah says:

IllSurah 34. Saba (46) (Part-22) ithat you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion.} This meaning was stated by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka*b, As-Suddi, Qatadah and others. ' This is what is meant by the Ayah. ijfJj jij* j* p} 4He is only a wamer to you in face of a severe torment.} Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on this Ayah: "One day, the Prophet climbed up As-Safa' and shouted, ilU-Li U» «0

people/» The Quraysh gathered around him, and said, 'What is the matter with you?' He said, 'What do you think? If I told you that the enemy were approaching and will reach us in the morning or in the evening, would you believe me? They said, 'Of course.' He said: 'I am a wamer to you in the face of a severe punishment.' Abu Lahab said, 'May you perish! You have called us together only to tell us this?' Then Allah revealed: 'Perish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish he!' (111:1) We have already discussed this in our Tafsir of the Ayah: 'And warn your tribe of near kindred' (26:214). (26:214). (26:214).

112 Tafsir Ibn Kathir: "Whatever wage I might have asked of you is yours. My wage is from Allah only, and He is a Witness over all things." 448. Say: "Verily, my Lord sends down the truth, the All-Knower of the Unseen." 449. Say: "The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect." 450. Say: "If (even) I go astray, I shall stray only to my own loss. But if I remain guided, it is because of the Revelation of my Lord to me. Truly, He is All-Hearer, Ever Near." I do not ask for any Reward for conveying the Message Allah commands His Messenger to say to the idolaters: 'Whatever wage I might have asked of you is yours.' meaning, 'I do not want anything for conveying the Message of Allah to you, advising you and telling you to worship Allah.' 'My wage is from Allah only,' means, 'rather I will seek the reward for that with Allah.'

and He is a Witness over all things. } means, 'He knows all things, and He knows everything about me and the manner in which I am conveying the Message to you, and He knows all about you.' 'Sm: "Verily, my Lord sends down the truth, the All-Knower of the Unseen." This is like the Ayah: 'He sends the Revelation by His command to any of His servants He wills of His servants among the people on earth, and He is the All-Knower of the Unseen; nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him in the heavens or on earth. "The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect." means, truth and the great Law have come from Allah, and falsehood has gone and has perished and vanished. This is like the Ayah: 'Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it is vanished' (21:18). When the Messenger of Allah entered Al-Masjid Al-Haram on

the day of the conquest of Makkah, and found those idols

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4701–4706]

standing around the Ka'bah, he started to hit the idols with his bow, reciting, 'The truth has come and the falsehood has vanished. Surely, the falsehood is ever bound to vanish.' (17:81), and:

114 Tafsir Ibn Kathir: "The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect." This was recorded by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasai. Say: "If (even) I go astray, I shall stray only to my own loss. But if I remain guided, it is because of the Revelation of my Lord to me . . ." means, all good comes from Allah, and in what Allah sends down of revelation and

clear truth there is guidance and wisdom. So whoever goes astray, does so by himself, as 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said when he was asked about some issue. He said, "I will say what I think, and if it is correct, then it is from Allah, and if it is wrong, then it is from me and from the Shaytān, and Allah and His Messenger have nothing to do with it."*21 Truly, He is All-Hearer, Ever Near.} means. He hears all the words of His servants, and He is always near to respond to them when they call on Him. An-Nasal recorded the Hadith of Abu Musa which also appears in the Two Sahih: Jt i Vj l) «You are not calling upon one who is deaf or absent; you are calling upon One Who is All-Hearer, Ever Near and Responsive.»[3 & it *ii i&==* % yfZi # 111 FathAl-Bari 8:252 , Muslim 3 : 1409 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :573 , An- Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:483 Abu Dawud 2 :589 An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :438 , Fath.Al-B&ri9 :157 , Muslim 4:2076

451. And if you could but see, when they will be terrified with no escape, and they will be seized from a near place. 452. And they will say: 'We do believe (now);' but how could they receive (Tanawush) from a place so far off.} 453. Indeed they did disbelieve before (in this world), and they (used to) conjecture about the Unseen, from a far place. 454. And a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire, as was done in the past with the people of their kind. Verily, they have been in grave doubt.} Here Allah says: 'if only you could see, O Muhammad, when these deniers are terrified on the Day of Resurrection, and they have no way of escape and nowhere to run to and no refuge.' and they will be seized from a near place.} means, they will not even be given the slightest chance of escape, but they will be seized from the first instant. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: "When they come forth from their graves." iAnd they will say: "We do believe (now);" means, on the Day of Resurrection, they will say, *we believe in Allah and His angels, Books and Messengers.' This is like the Ayah: iAnd if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) : "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty." (32:12) Allah says: iBut how could they receive from a place so far off?} Af-Tabari 20:423.

117 Surah 34. Saba (51 - 54) (Part-22) iWe do not think it but as a conjecture, and we have no firm convincing belief. (45:32). Qatadah and Mujahid said, "Their belief that there would be no resurrection, no Paradise and no Hell was based on mere conjecture." ^And a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak and others, This means faith."*2 ' As-Suddi said: iAnd a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire,} means "Repentance."*3 ' This was also the view of Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. Mujahid said: iAnd a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire,} means, "This world and its wealth, luxuries and people."14' Something similar was narrated from Ibn "Umar, Ibn 'Abbas and Ar-Ra'bi bin Anas, may Allah be pleased with him. It is also the opinion of Al-Bukhari and the Group. The correct view is that there is no contradiction between the two views, for a barrier will be set between them and what they desire in this world, and what they seek in the Hereafter will be denied from them. 4 J*» (S') 4as was done in the past with the people of their kind.} means, as happened to the nations of the past who disbelieved in the Messengers; when the punishment of Allah came upon At-Tabari 20:429. |2' At-Tabari 20:430. 13' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :7 15 141 At-Tabari 20:431.

them, they wished that they had believed, but this was not accepted from them. <d« ^ f-brj jti li*t* IjJli CX Ij A'vi tj oJi- j5 ,j1f iii C,t ijtj Q 4So, to/ien they saw Our punishment, they said: 'We believe in

Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as (His) partners. "Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants. And there the disbelievers lost utterly. (40:84-85). 4Verily, they have been in grave doubt. means, in this world they had doubts, so their faith will not be accepted from them when they behold the punishment with their own eyes. Qatadah said, "Beware of doubt. For whoever dies doubting, will be raised doubting; and whoever dies believing, with certainty will be raised believingwith certainty."

Surah 35: Fatir

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4707]

Opening The TafslrofSurah Fatir (Chapter - 35)

Which was revealed inMakkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4707–4752]

i-sgfl^0P In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 42 . A// praise is due to Allah, Fatir of the heavens and the earth, Who made the angels messengers with wings, two or three or four. He increases in creation what He wills. Verily, Allah is Able to do all things.) The Power ofAllah Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I did not know what Fatir As-Samawati wal-Ard meant until two bedouins came to me disputing over a well. One of them said to his companion, ‘Ana Fatartuha,’ meaning, I started it.”¹¹¹ Ibn ‘AbbSs, may Allah be pleased with him, also said, 0^ iFatir of the heavens and the earth,) means, “The Originator of the heavens and the earth.”¹²¹ Ad- Dahhak said, “Every time the phrase Fatir As-Samaw&ti wal- Ard. is used in the Qur’an, it means the Creator of the heavens and the earth.”^{*31} iWho made the angels messengers) means, between Him and His Prophets. 1,1 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3 *31 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3

4with wings} means, with which they fly to convey quickly that which they have been commanded to convey. I??*‘ ‘ <1 4two or three or four.} means, among them are some who have two wings, some have three and some who have four. Some have more than that, as stated in the Hadith mentioning that the Messenger of Allah jfe saw Jibril, peace be upon him, on the Night of the Isra’ with six hundred wings. Between each pair of wings was a distance like that between the east and the west. Allah says: }& if&M c4 *h» 1*^ 4He increases in creation what He wills. Verily, Allah is Able to do all things.} As-Suddi said, “He increases their wings and creates them as He wills.”¹²¹ k % *eU 1 5 ^*uu -on 42 . Whatever of mercy, Allah may grant to mankind, none can withhold it; and whatever He may withhold, none can grant it thereafter. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise.} None can withhold the Mercy ofAllah Allah tells us that what He wills, happens, and what He does not will, does not happen. None can give what He withholds, and none can withhold what He gives. Imam Ahmad recorded that Warrad, the freed slave of Al- Mughlrah bin Shu'bah, said, “Mu'awiyah wrote to Al-Mughlrah bin Shu'bah, saying, ‘Write for me what you heard from the Messenger of Allah Hg.’ So Al-Mughlrah called me and I wrote for him: *1 heard the Messenger of Allah 3^5 say when he finished praying, 111 FathAl-Bari 6:361. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :4

k <5 i<J vLLj^Ji- N qJl>-j <1>1 Vj iJj «1Jl iLL IJi li ^ Vj U Vj U£U N ^ili “There is no god (worthy of worship) except Allah alone, with no partner or associate. To Him be praise and dominion, and He is able to do all things. O Allah, there is none who can withhold what You give, and none can give what You withhold, and good fortune and richness in anything cannot benefit one against Your will . ‘And I heard him forbid gossiping, asking too many questions and wasting money, burying girls alive, disobeying one’s mother, and withholding from others while asking from them.”¹¹¹ This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim, with several chain of narration.¹²¹ It was recorded in Sahih Muslim that Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When the Messenger of Allah raised his head from bowing, he would say: ‘* O-fJ .u^Jl dlj iu fc -Lp lllSj -LaJI JIJ U frliijl i Jinj - •X>Jl Shf -X>Jl li 'j U) Jjkil Vj *UAL tU V gill “Allah hears those who praise Him. O Allah, our Lord, to You be praise, filling the heavens and the earth, and filling whatever You wish besides. O Allah, the One deserving praise and glory. The truest words that any servant says - and all of us are Your servants - are: O Allah, there is none who can withhold what You give, and none can give what You withhold, and no wealth or majesty can benefit anyone against Your will.¹³¹ This Ayah is like the Ayah } yi ji ji) yi ji. iAnd if Allah touches you with harm, there is none who can remove it but He; and if He intends any good for you, there is none who can repel His favor} (10:107). Ahmad 4:250. Fath Al-Bari 2 :378 11 : 137, 521, Muslim 1 :414, 415. Muslim 1 :347

And there are many similar Ayat. &^ J.& *li> Jf. gi- > >lk V «U' O' £ VI 4 43 . O mankind! Remember the grace of Allah upon you! Is there any creator other than Allah who provides for you from the sky (rain) and the earth? La ilaha ila Huwa. How then are you turning away (from Him)?} The Evidence of Tawhid Allah shows His servants that they should worship Him Alone, for just as He is Independent in His power of creation and provision, so He should be worshipped Alone with no partners or associates such as idols and false gods. So Allah says: cm J tr« vmm ' -i.t ,""i” 1 > • **§?“ > ' ht ‘ ' ' (_>l IjyiJ v'7 , r- // * * x u // C y//- # «V iifiy 4^j3? % vi% v> }La ilaha ila Huwa. How then are you turning away (from Him)?} meaning, ‘how can you turn away from Him after this has been made clear and this proof has been made obvious, but you still worship idols and false gods?’ And Allah knows best. a^ \&& gu jf>& j.& &&& i0

44. And if they deny you, so were Messengers denied before you. And to Allah return all matters . 45. O mankind! Verily, the promise of Allah is true. So, let not this present life deceive you, and let not the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah. 46. Surely, Shaytan is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. He only invites his followers that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire. Consolation in the fact that the previous Messengers were denied, and a reminder of the Resurrection Allah says: ‘Even if these idolators who associate others with Allah disbelieve in you, O Muhammad, and go against the Message of Tawhid that you have brought, you have an example in the Messengers who came before you.’ They also brought a clear Message to their people and told them to worship Allah alone, but their people denied them and went against them. g-y fd fy} 4And to Allah return all matters (for decision).} means, “We will requite them for that in full.’ Then Allah says: 4 j>- jai oj. 40 mankind! Verily, the promise of Allah is true.} meaning the Resurrection will undoubtedly come to pass. 4Qtf >£££ *} 4So, let not this present life deceive you,} means, this life is as nothing in compare to the great good that Allah has promised to His close friends and the followers of His Messengers, so do not

let these transient attractions distract you from that which is lasting.' 4and let not the chiefdeceiver deceive you about Allah.}

This refers to Shaytan, as stated by Ibn 'Abbas,' ' may Allah be pleased with him. Meaning, do not let the Shaytan tempt you and divert you away from following the Messengers of Allah and believing what they say, for he is the chief deceiver and arch-liar. This Ayah is like the Ayah that appears at the end of Surah Luqmdn: o it ato ilet not then this (worldly) present life deceive you, nor let the chiefdeceiver deceive you about Allah^ (31:33). Then Allah tells us of the enmity of Iblis towards the sons of Adam: iSurely, Shaytan is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. meaning, "he has declared his enmity towards you, so be even more hostile towards him, oppose him and do not believe the things with which he tries to tempt you.' Q>\\$ 4He only invites his followers that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} means, "he only wants to misguide you so that you will enter the blazing Fire with him.' This is a manifest enemy, and we ask Allah, the All-Powerful and Almighty to make us enemies of Shaytan and to make us followers of the Book of Allah and of the way of His Messengers. For He is able to do whatever He wills and He will respond to all supplication. This is like the Ayah: 'ip Ip Crt^ awtdiU Ji !)J £ j&J (Uj ot 4And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves unto Adam." So they prostrated themselves except Iblis. He was one of the Jinn; he disobeyed the command of his Lord. Will you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as m At-Tabari 20 :438

protectors and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers .> (18:50) ^ (3 £«* jjb Xil Z>\% jii 05 * ^ 54 * J* if\$ "to .<£ 2£ ^ .A.0 U. tSc. ILl 47. Those who disbelieve, theirs will be a severe torment; and those who believe and do righteous good deeds, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward 48. Is he, then, to whom the evil of his deeds is made fairseeming, so that he considers it as good? Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills, and guides whom He wills. So destroy not yourself in sorrowfor them. Truly, Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat they do!} The Punishment of the Disbeliever and the Reward of the Believer on the Day ofResurrection Having stated that the ultimate destiny of the followers of Iblls will be the blazing Fire, Allah then tells us that for those who disbelieve there will be a severe punishment. This is because they obeyed the Shaytan and disobeyed Ar-Rahman. And He tells us that those who believed in Allah and His Messengers 4"^\ 4and do righteous good deeds, theirs will be forgiveness^ meaning, from whatever sins they did, 4and a great reward for the good deeds that they did. Then Allah says: 4lO- «U> .4^ •>* /J& 41s he, then, to whom the evil ofhis deeds is made fairseeming, so that he considers it as good? \$ meaning, 'such as disbelievers or immoral persons who do evil deeds and believe that they are doing something good, i.e., a person who is like that has been misguided by Allah, so what

can you do for him? You cannot help him at all.' 4 ij* J {j* ^ 4Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills. means according to His decree. 4<£>/"* ctLOi 4So destroy not yourself in sorrozofor them.\$ means, do not grieve about that, for Allah is Wise in His decree and He leaves astray whomsoever He leaves astray, and He guides whomsoever He guides, and in doing so He has perfect knowledge and wisdom. Allah says: 4o£1m C pie iif iTuiy, Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat they do!\$ Xffy. Am J>)i\ * LvJi clS JI. '(Xef jiZi ^fff\ 3ji' ,P5 iiii %i\ Ilf '!'>j' 4* of *1 45 ^ *j5 Jli? c r ,1 .-f' 't - •* -4 --rf* i{ ,i - ly *J ip' 0} J*-*1 IkU 1 jkj 4jJco yy Ip >*' <£^ oj, 4 ^ oj 49. And it is Allah Who sends the winds, so that they raise up the clouds, and We drive them to a dead land, and revive therewith the

earth after its death. As such (will be) the Resurrection!} 420. Whosoever desires Al-'Izzah then to Allah belongs Al- 'Izzah. To Him ascend the good words, and the righteous deeds exalt it, but those who plot evils, theirs will be a severe torment. And the plotting of such will perish 422 . And Allah did create you from dust, then from Nutfah then He made you pairs. And no female conceives or gives birth but with His knowledge. And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easy for Allah. See volume six, the explanation of Surat Al-Hajj 22 :4, and Surat Al- Mu'minun 23 :13 in volume six.

127 Surah 35. Fatir (9-11) (Part-22) Evidence of Life after Death Often Allah refers to the Resurrection by using the analogy of the earth coming back to life after it has died, as in the beginning of Surat Al-Hajj, where He urges His servants to draw the lesson of the former from the latter. For the earth is dead and lifeless, with nothing growing in it, then He sends to it clouds which bring water, which He sends down upon it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth)} (22:5). So too, when Allah wishes to resurrect the bodies, He will send rain from beneath the Throne which will cover the whole earth, and the bodies will grow in their graves like seeds grow in the earth. It says in the Sahih: > Z + > > * / ' . * * • “Every part of the son of Adam will disintegrate apart from the coccyx, from which he was created and from him he will be made anew.*^ Allah says: li i As such (will be) the Resurrection!} According to the Hadith of Abu Razin: “I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, how will Allah bring the dead back to life? What is the sign of that in His creation?’ He^ said: aj Ojy Ui “O Abu Razin, do you not pass through the valley of your people (and see it) arid and barren, then you pass through it (and see it) stirred (to life) and green? I said, ‘Yes.’ He said: «77ius will Allah bring the dead back to life . l2) ,1] Muslim 4:2271. ^ Ahmad 4: 12.

Honor, Power and Glory in this World and in the Hereafter come only by obeying Allah 4 Whosoever desires Al-'Izzah then to Allah belongs all Al- 'Izzah.} means, whoever desires honor, power and glory in this world and the next, let him be obedient towards Allah, may He be exalted. This will help him reach his goal, for Allah is the Sovereign of this world and the Hereafter, and to Him belong all honor, power and glory. This is like the Ayat. k \Jf\ oji lyti jyi m i Those who take disbelievers for protectors instead of believers, do they seek Al-'Izzah with them? Verily, then to Allah belongs all honor, power and glory. (4:139) iU*. k k && i And let not their speech grieve you, for all Al-'Izzah belongs to Allah (10:65). Al-'Izzah belongs to Allah, and to His Messenger, and to the believers, but the hypocrites know not} (63:8). Mujahid said: iWlwhoever desires Al-'Izzah means, by worshipping idols. } then to Allah belongs Al-'Izzah}. ^ Whosoever desires Al-'Izzah then to Allah belongs Al-'Izzah.} means, let him seek honor, power and glory through obeying 111 At-Tabari 20:443.

Allah, may He be glorified.' 1 ' Righteous Deeds ascend to Allah i' 4 To Him ascend the good words,} means, words of remembrance, recitation of Qur'an, and supplications. This was the view of more than one of the Salaf. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Mukhariq bin Sulaym said that “Abdullah bin Mas*ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said to them, “If we tell you a Hadith, we will bring you proof of it from the Book of Allah. When the Muslim servants say, ‘Glory and praise be to Allah, there is no god worthy of worship except Allah, Allah is Most Great and blessed be Allah,’ an angel takes these words and puts them under his wing, then he ascends with them to the heaven. He does not take them past any group of angels but they seek forgiveness for the one who said them, until he brings them before Allah, may He

be glorified.” Then ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, recited: 4iii ^3f 4To Him ascend the good words, and the righteous deeds exalt it}.™ Imam Ahmad recorded that An-Nu‘man bin Bashir, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah jfe said: i£j 1 a! 1 j oJL «>»— fj «ill 2ll JjjJl 8 jcjp J J \ nThose who remember Allah and glory Allah by saying, ‘Glory be to Allah, Allah is most Great, all praise is due to Allah and La ilaha illdlldh, these words go around the Throne buzzing like bees, mentioning those who said them. Wotdd one of you not like to have something with Allah mentioning him?*” 111 At-Jabari 20:444. 2| At-Tabari 20 :444 ’ Ahmad 4:268.

This was also recorded by Ibn Majah.' {and the righteous deeds exalt it}. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The good word is the remembrance of Allah, may He be exalted, which is taken up to Allah, and the righteous deed is the performance of obligatory duties. Whoever remembers Allah when doing an obligatory duty, his deed carries his remembrance of Allah and takes it up to Allah, may He be exalted. Whoever remembers Allah and does not perform the obligatory duties, his words will be rejected, as will his deed.”121 {but those who plot evils,} Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Shahr bin Hawshab said, “This refers to those who show off by their actions,”3 ' i.e., they deceive the people by giving the impression that they are obeying Allah, when in fact they are hated by Allah for showing off. Allah says: theirs will be severe torment. And the plotting of such will perish.} meaning, it will fail and vanish, for their reality is apparent from up close to those who have insight and wisdom. No one conceals a secret but Allah will cause it to become known, on his face or by a slip of the tongue, or He will cause the person to wear it like a cloak (so that everyone will see it). If it is good, then the consequences will be good, and if it is bad, then the consequences will be bad. The person who shows off cannot continue to deceive anyone but the fool, but the believers who have insight are not deceived by that; from up close, they soon discover it. And nothing at all can be hidden from the Knower of the Unseen (Allah). m Ibn Majah 2:1252. At-Tabari 20 :445 Pl At-Tabari 20 :447

231Surah 35. Fatir (9-11) (Part-22) Allah is the Creator and Knower of the Unseen 4And Allah did create you from dust, then from Nutfah,} means. He initiated the creation of your father Adam from dust, then He created his offspring from semen of worthless water. i then He made you pairs means, male and female, as a kindness and a mercy from Him, He gave you partners from your own kind, that you may find repose in them. iAnd no female conceives or gives birth but with His knowledge. means, He knows about that and nothing is hidden from Him at all, but, 4n 4 inot a leaffalls, but He knows it. There is not a grait in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record (6:59) We have already discussed in this respect in the Ayah: U) JaJu Cj Jil fcjc li 0/jL, iAllah knows what every female bears, and by how much the wombs fall short or exceed. Everything with Hint is in (due) proportion . All-Knower of the unseen and the seen, the Most Great, the Most High.} (13:8-9). Oi X> _/ *» oi _r^i k>r" / ^And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but is in a Book.\$ means, some of those sperm are granted a long life, which He knows and it is recorded with Him in the First Book.

it 'ij} inor is a part cut off from his life,} Here the pronoun (his) refers to mankind in general, not to a specific person, because the long life which is recorded in the Book and is known by Allah will not be cut off. It was reported via Al-‘Awfi that Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning the Ayah, t> *s&i oj. cl 4And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is

easy for Allah .} There is no one for whom Allah has decreed a long life but he will reach the age that has been decreed for him. When he reaches the time that has been decreed for him, he will not surpass it. And there is no one for whom Allah has decreed a short life but it will end when he reaches the age that has been decreed for him. Allah says: itf . \$ i > 'o\ L&" 4\ it "ifr inor is a part ait offfrom his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easyfor Allah.} He said, "That is recorded in a Book with Him." This was also the view of Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim. On the other hand, some of them said, "The phrase 4And no aged man is granted a length of life} means, what He decrees for him of life, and - f-. it inor is a part cut offfrom his life} means, his time is constantly decreasing. All of this is known to Allah year after year, month after month, week after week, day after day, hour after hour. Everything is written with Allah in His Book."This was reported by Ibn Jarir from Abu Malik,*2 * and was also the view of As- I* 1 At-Jabari 20:447. At-Tabari 20:447.

133Surah 35. Fatir (12) (Part-22 Suddi and 'Ata' Al- Khurasani. In the Tafsir of this Ayah, An-Nasa'i recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah % say: Aijj «J Ja-4; if v- lr" ,j\ j a Ujj «Whoever would like to have ample provision and a long life, let hint uphold the ties of kinship .n"11 ' It was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, Muslim and Abu Dawud.12 jit jc Ja-i -,!> 4Surely , that is easy for Allah means, that is very easy for Him, and He has detailed knowledge of all His creation, for His knowledge encompasses all things, and nothing at all is hidden from Him. ojkJa \$ Op Mr- > Ujf i* £& 'j£ V, CJ 412. And the two seas (kinds of water) are not alike : this is palatable, sweet and pleasant to drink, and that is salty and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra. 6:438. Fath Al-B&ri 4 :553 , Muslim 4 :1982 , Abu Dawud 2 :32 1

bitter. And from them both you eat fresh tender meat (fish), and derive the ornaments that xjou wear. And you see the ships cleaving, that you may seek of His bounty, and that you may give thanks. The Blessings and Signs ofAllah Allah says, pointing out His mighty power in creating different things, how He has created the two seas (kinds of water). The fresh, palatable sea (kind of water) refers to the rivers which flow among people, rivers great and small according to people's needs in all regions and areas and lands. This water is sweet and palatable for whoever wants to drink it. iand that is salty and bitter.} means, unpalatable. This is the ocean in which the big ships sail, and is salty and undrinkable. Allah says: i^\ iand that is salty and bitter.} Then Allah says: iAnd from them both you eat fresh tender meat,} meaning, fish. iand derive the ornaments that you wear.} This is like the Ayah: i% sc\$ p} iOut of them both come out pearl and coral. Tlten which of the blessings of your Lord will you both (Jinn and men) deny?} (55 :22-23). ijSfro dSif JjJ} iAnd you see the ships cleaving,} means, they travel through it, plowing through the water with their beak-shaped bows. Mujahid said, "The wind drives the ships, and the wind cannot drive any ships except the big ones.

ithat you may seek ofHis bounty,} means, through yourjourneys to engage in trade from one land to another. iand that you may give thanks.} means, that you may give thanks to your Lord for subjugating this mighty creation - the sea - to you, so that you can travel through it as you wish and go wherever you want, and nothing stops you; His power has subjugated for you whatever is in the heavens and on earth, and all of this is by His grace and mercy. iifk Jill!! J Qyj 4 ^4 . iss jj;^ gtsact# jg #3B yz* ji>24 « 34 a?. 553 ^23. He merges the night into the day, and He merges the day into the night. And He has subjected the sun and the moon, each runs its course for a term appointed. Such is AUah, your Lord;

His is the kingdom. And those, whom you invoke or call upon instead of Him, own not even a Qihmr.} \$14. If you invoke them, they hear your call; and if (in case) they were to hear, they could not grant it to you. And on the Day of Resurrection, they will disown your worshipping them. And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} The gods of the Idolaters do not even own a Qipnir. Another aspect of His perfect power and might is that He has subjugated the night with its darkness and the day with its light. He takes from the length of the one and adds it to the shortness of the other, until they become equal. Then He takes from the latter and adds to the former, so one becomes long and the other becomes short, so they take from one another in summer and in winter. 4 And He has subjected the sun and the moon,}

136 TafcTr Ibn Kathir and the stars and planets, with their light. All of them run in their appointed courses and in the manner prescribed for them, as decreed by the Almighty, All-Knowing. (each runs its course for a term appointed.) means, until the Day of Resurrection. (Such is Allah, pour Lord?) means, the One Who has done all this is the Almighty Lord besides Whom there is no other true God. •Aj-> cn oy-j. (And those, whom you invoke or call upon instead of Him,) means, 'the idols and false gods whom you claim to be in the form of angels who are close to Allah,' (own not even a Qitmir.) Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, 'Ata', 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, Al-Hasan, Qata-dah and others said, "This is the thread that is attached to the pit of a date."11 * In other words, they do not possess anything in the heavens or on earth, not even anything equivalent to this Qitmir. Then Allah says: (if you invoke them, they hear not your call;) means, 'the gods upon whom you call instead of Allah, do not hear your supplication, because they are inanimate and have no soul in them.' 4 ift&cLj C \jj) (and if (in case) they were to hear, they could not grant it to you.) means, 'they are not able to do any of the things that you ask them for.' hi At-Tabari 20 :453

4 And on the Day of Resurrection, they will disown your worshipping them} means, 'they will disown you.' This is like the Ayat 4 i'-'jf !?. 4 & J. V ir 1 <j>' jjJ Ji !>*** j— 4 I 1 sOJULS. 4 And who is more astray than one who calls on besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they (false deities) will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping .} (46:5-6), and 4 And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.} (19:81-82) 4jS& 4 And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} means, no one can tell you about the consequences of things and how they will end like the One Who is the All-Knower of them. Qatadah said, "He is referring to Himself, may He be blessed and exalted, for He undoubtedly tells the truth." JCj -X 4 iJrji-P" \$s> ci[tub Xy ^ <3* Cjfc ^ C2l &S 6\$ J12 V l^L>r 415. O mankind! it is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is the Rich, Worthy of all praise.} 416. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation.} 417. And that is not hard for Allah.} IM At-Tabaii 20 :454

138 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr 418. And no bearer of burdens shall bear another's burden; and if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin. You can roam only those who fear their Lord unseen and perform the Salah. And he who purifies himself (from all kinds of sins), then he purifies only for the benefit of himself. And to Allah is the Return (of all).} Mankind is in need of Allah, and each Person will carry His own Burdens on the Day of Resurrection

Allah tells us that He has no need of anyone or anything else, but all of creation is in need of Him and is in a position of humility before Him. He says: 40 mankind! it is you who stand in need of Allah.} meaning, they need Him in all that they do, but He has no need of them at all. Allah says: 41 But Allah is the Rich, Worthy of all praise.} meaning, He is unique in His being Free of all needs, and has no partner or associate, and He is Worthy of all praise in all that He does, says, decrees and legislates. 42 If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation .} means, if He wanted to, He could destroy you and bring forth another people, and this is not difficult or impossible for Him. He says: 43 And that is not hard for Allah.} Allah's saying: 44 And no bearer of burdens shall bear another's burden;} means, on the Day of Resurrection.

45 And if the person who is carrying a heavy burden calls someone else to help him carry his load, all or part of it, 46 nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin. means, even if he is closely-related to him, even if he is his father or son, for each person will be preoccupied with his own self and his own situation. Then Allah says: 47 Only those who fear their Lord unseen and perform the Salah.} means, *the only ones who will draw a lesson from what you have brought are those .who are possessed of insight and wisdom, who fear their Lord and who do as He commands.' 48 And he who purifies himself, then he purifies only for the benefit of himself.} means, who does righteous deeds, the benefit of that will come back to him.

49 And to Allah is the Return .} means, to Him everything will ultimately return, and He is swift in bringing to account. He will reward or punish everyone according to his deeds: if they are good, then the end will be good, and if they are bad, then the end will be bad. 50 And the blind and the seeing.} 420. Nor are the depths of darkness and light.} 421 . Nor are the shade and the sun's heat.} 422. Nor are the living and the dead. Verily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear, but you cannot make hear those who are in graves.} 423. You are only a wamer.} 424. Verily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a wamer. And there never was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} 425. And if they deny you, those before them also denied. Their Messengers came to them with clear signs, and with the Scriptures, and with the Book giving light.} 426. Then I took hold of those who disbelieved, and how terrible was My denial!} The Believer and the Disbeliever are not equal Allah says that these antonyms are clearly not equal, the blind and the seeing are not equal, there is a difference and a huge gap between them. Darkness and light are not equal, neither are shade and the sun's heat. By the same token, the living and the dead are not equal. This is the parable Allah makes of the believers who are the living, and the disbelievers who are

141 Surah 35. Fatir (19 - 26) (Part-22 the dead. This is like the Ayat k 4 & * ft o4 41s he who was dead and We gave him life and set for him a light (of belief) whereby he can walk amongst men - like him who is in the (depths of) darkness from which he can never come out?) (6:122), J* sft 4The parable of the two parties is as that of the blind and the deaf and the seer and the hearer. Are they equal when compared?) (11:24) The believer sees and hears, and walks in the light upon a straight path in this world and the Hereafter, until he comes to settle in Gardens (Paradise) wherein is shade and springs.

The disbeliever is blind and deaf, walking in darkness from which he cannot escape, he is lost in his misguidance in this world and the Hereafter, until he end', up in fierce hot wind and boiling water, and shadow of black smoke, neither cool nor good. ^ jjT j\} iVerily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear,} means. He guides them to listen to the proof and accept it and adhere it. 4 <j O' gv— ibut you cannot make hear those who are in graves.} means, 'just as the dead cannot benefit from guidance and the call to truth after they have died as disbelievers and ended up in the graves, so too you cannot help these idolators who are decreed to be doomed, and you cannot guide them.' 4You are only a wamer} means, 'all you have to do is to convey the Message and warn them, and Allah leaves astray whomso- ever He wills and guides whomsoever He wills.'

242 Tafslr Ibn KathJr Ijfria dllSijl TSl^ iVerily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a ivamer.} means, a bearer of glad tidings to the believers and a wamer to the disbelievers. i'ji£& 4\ *5,1 £ f/iere newer was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} means, there was never any nation among the sons of Adam but Allah sent wamers to them, and left them with no excuse. This is like the Ayat. iYou are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide (13:7). iSYk o* ii' biic' iSl ^ (JZ j3\j} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah, and avoid all false deities." Then of them were some whom Allah guided and of them were some upon whom the straying was justified} (16:36). And there are many similarAyat |*4-by <l>i js iAnd if they deny you, those before them also denied. Their Messengers came to them with clear signs,} means, clear miracles and definitive proofs. iand with the Scriptures,} means, the Books. iand with the Book giving light.} means, clear and obvious.

iThen I took hold of those who disbelieved,\$ means, 'despite all of this, they denied the Messengers and the Message they brought, so I seized them, i.e., with My punishment.' iand how terrible zoas My denial means, 'how great and intense and terrible do you think My punishment was?' And Allah knows best. j-*»r Cftj a. j* jjji ill' 3 <(27. Sec i/o» not that Allah sends down water from the ski/, and We produce therewith fruits of various colors, and among the mountains are judad, white and red, ofvarying colors and (others) Gharabib black,f i28 . And likewise, men and moving creature and cattle are of various colors. It is only those among His servants who have knozoledge that fear Allah. Verily, Allah is Almighty, Oft- Forgiving.] The Perfect Power ofAllah Allah tells us of His complete and perfect power of creation. He tells us how He makes different kinds of things from one thing, which is the water that He sends down from the heaven. From water He brings forth fruits of various colors, yellow, red, green, white and other colors, as we can see in the immense variety of their colors, tastes and scents. This is like another Ayah where Allah says: yy? cy, (Xt jff ^Cl* ol j . 'jo AAnd in the earth are neighbouring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops, and date palms, growing into two or three from a single stem root, or otherwise, zoatered with the same zuater; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Verily, in these things there are Ayat for the

people who understand.} (13:4) 4<?i» ' ' ' f-* 11' jf ' -•). *-J o*??. Jj*- Ovn' crl>r iand among the mountains are Judad, white and red, of varying colors} means. He created the mountains like this, with different colors, as we also see that there are indeed white and red mountains, and in some of them there are streaks which are also of varying colors. Ibn 'Abbas said Al-Judad means pathways. This was also the view of Abu Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi. And there are some mountains which are very

black. 'Ikrimah said, u Al-Gharabtb means mountains which are high and black. This was also the view of Abu Malik, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and Qatadah. 111 Ibn Jarir said, "When the Arabs describe something as being very black, they say Ghirbib." iAnd likewise, men and moving creatures and cattle are of various colors.} means, the same is true of living creatures too, humans and animals, all creatures which walk on their feet, and cattle. Here something general is followed by something specific. These are all different too, for among mankind there are Berbers, Ethiopians and some non-Arabs who are very black, and Slavs and Romans who are very white, and the Arabs who are in between, and the Indians. Allah says in another Ayah: iand the difference of your languages and colors. Verily, in that are indeed signsfor men ofsound knowledge} (30:22). Similarly, animals and cattle vary in their colors, even within one species, and a single animal may have patches of different colors. Blessed be Allah, the Best of creators. Allah then says: (i| At-Tabari 20:461

145Surah 35. Fdtir (27 - 28) (Part-22 ilt is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah. meaning, only those who have knowledge truly fear Him as He should be feared, because the more they know about the Almighty, All-Powerful, All-Knowing Who has the most perfect attributes and is described with the most beautiful Names, the more they will fear Him. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah: ilt is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah.} those who know that Allah is able to do all things.' ' Ibn 'Abbas said, "The one among His servants who knows about Ar-Rahman, is the one who does not associate anything in worship with Him; the one who accepts as lawful that which He has permitted and accepts as unlawful that which He has prohibited. He obeys His commands and is certain that he will meet Him and be brought to account for his deeds. Said bin Jubayr said, "Fear is what stands between you and disobeying Allah, may He be glorified." Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "The knowledgeable person is the one who fears Ar-Rahman with regard to the Unseen, who likes that which Allah wants him to like, and who shuns that which angers Allah." Then Al-Hasan recited: Si* <54. l j£&* it Si* t j&. ilt is only those among His servants who have knowledge that fear Allah. Verily, AllHh is Almighty, Oft-Forgiving.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from Abu Hayyan At-Taymi from a man who said, "It used to be said that the knowledgeable are of three types: (first) one who knows Allah and the command of Allah, (second) one who knows Allah but does not know the command of Allah, and (third) one who knows the command of Allah but does not know Allah. The one who knows Allah and the command of Allah is the one who fears m At-Tabari 20 :462

Allah and knows the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties {Fara'id). The one who knows Allah but does not know the command of Allah is the one who fears Allah but does not know the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties (Fara'id). The one who knows the command of Allah but does not know Allah is the one who knows the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties (Fara'id) but does not fear Allah." U fab 1 \$ Of &A fa& fat j Z4. <&£ 129. Verily, those who recite the Book of Allah, and perform the Saldh, and spend out of what We have provided for them, secretly and openly, they hope for a (sure) trade-gain that will never perish.^ 130. That He may pay them their wages in foil, and give them (even) more, out of His grace. Verily, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Ready to appreciate. TheMuslims willbe the OnesWho gain in the Hereafter Here Allah tells us that His believing servants, who recite and believe in His Book, and do the deeds prescribed in it such as establishing regular prayer at the prescribed times, night and day, spending (in charity) out of that which Allah has provided for them secretly and openly,

itlley hopefor a (sure) trade-gain that will never perish.)> means, they hope for a reward from Allah which will inevitably be theirs. Allah says: iThat He may pay them their wages in full, and give them (even) more, out ofHis grace. meaning, that He may give them a reward for what they have done, and multiply it by adding more, such as has never occurred to them. ijfa

dA^JzJ L^L>^^{^1 »Alt^I(jul^ jS> ujLoiA»Jkc^-*" <j?o i^>-t> •«' •— > ^ > <- if-% •:ti (jyL^l^yi- Ju(lj^O*liiJ- flp_A-^=L)IJ^il4JI ^JJfCi D&SBB& %\<Verily, He is Oft- Forgiving, means, He forgives their sins, „Sf«e— A 0^lc..^fli t ^ *.. s r . ' -J-' p^a. > . '-As '1 'nf.'tv' I<" J^yL^== ' s<4><fttUji v^ij V-'if- v . -ft"? i* i . •" T" *<ir _/^==aj^jC ^ ^ ^ ^ I ^ ^ Z f> l^^?lC --Xffr - : iMost Ready to appreciate. means, He appreciates even a lit- tle of their good deeds. Crt tLS[b->j^ c£3j^ £q > J&i 1a->J *oLjU 4jil oi Jo 431 . And what We have revealed to you of the Book, it is the (very) truth confirming that which was (revealed) be- fore it. Verily, Allah is indeed All-Aware and All-Seer of His servants The Qur'an isThe true Book ofAllah 4&i Vf4 4And what We have revealed to you\$ - 'O Muhammad, of the Book,' i.e., the Qur'an, 4%z*qi&&\» iit is the (very) truth confirming that which was (revealed) before it.\$ means, of the previous books. It confirms them just as they bore witness to the coming of the Qur'an and that it would be sent down from the Lord of the worlds.

these are the ones who do obligatory actions and things which are encouraged, and who avoid doing unlawful and disliked actions, and avoid some actions which are permissible. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah: iThen We gave the Book as inheritance to such ofOur servants whom We chose.} "This refers to the Ummah of Muhammad jg. Allah caused it to inherit every Book that He had revealed; those who wrong themselves will be forgiven, those who follow a middle course will have an easy accounting, and those who are foremost in good deeds will enter Paradise without being brought to account." 1 Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani reported from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger of Allah jg said one day: •^f It JX&\ ji.ui. "Mi/ intercession will be for those among my Ummah who commit major sins Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Those who are foremost in good deeds will enter Paradise without being brought to account; those who follow a middle course will enter Paradise by the mercy of Allah; and those who wrong themselves and Ashab Al-A'raf2 * will enter Paradise by the intercession ofMuhammad 2s." It was also reported from a number of the Salaf that those among this Ummah who wrong themselves are still among those whom Allah has chosen, even though they are imperfect and fell short [by not adhering to the straight path]. Others said that those who wrong themselves are not part of this Ummah and are not among those whom Allah has chosen and who inherited the Book. The correct view is that they are also part of this Ummah. 111 At-Tabari 20:465. ' See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf7 :46| ' At-Tabarani 11 : 189.

The Virtues ofthe Scholars The scholars are the most fortunate of people with regard to this blessing, and the most entitled to this mercy. Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Qays bin Kathir said, "One of the people of Al-Madinah came to Abu Ad- Darda', may Allah be pleased with him, when he was in Damascus. [Abu Ad-Darda'] said, 'What brought you here, my brother?' He said, 'A Hadith which I heard that you narrate from the Messenger of Allah jg.' He said, 'Have you come for trade?' He said, 'No.' He said, 'Have you come for any other reason?' He said, "No.' He said, "Have you come only to seek this Hadith?' He said, "Yes. He, may Allah be pleased with him said, *1 heard

the Messenger of Allah jg say: jlj i£>jl JI h-i— i LJ uP OiLi. oljOJLJI ^JUdi aSj k ilia] U>J fajl\ J JbUil jJUit J~aij i*UJl jl^»JI ^>- ^jS'lj 'ij ijiLj \f'yfi jj tdVi 01} i.dVi £}} jd iUliii 01} ^13^1 y;u Ja>u JU-I JL>-1 i jvJlxJl 1yjj tOlj ^ ^Whoever fallows a path to seek knmvledge, Allah will shmo him the way to Paradise. The angels lower their wings being pleased with the one who seeks knowledge. Whoever is in the heavens and on earth, even the fish in the sea, ask far forgiveness far the scholar. The superiority of the scholar over the worshipper is like that of the moon over all other heavenly bodies. The scholars are the heirs of the Prophets, for the Prophets did not leave behind Dinars and Dirhams, but they left behind knowledge; and whoever receives it, receives an abundance ofgoodfortune It was also reported by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah.*21 &V£ ^0; %% y* ot u4 jC CD si; #3 £; <<4 d h idi 111 Ahmad 5:196. * Abu Dawud 4:157, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :450 , Ibn Majah 1:81.

433. 'Adn (Gardens) zuill they enter, therein will they be adorned zoith bracelets of gold and pearls, and their garments therein will be of silk. 434. And they will say: "All praise and thanks be to Allah, Wlw has removedfrom us (all) grief. Verily, our Lord is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Ready to appreciate."} 435. "Who, out ofHis grace, has lodged us in a home that will last forever, where toil will touch us not nor weariness will touch us."} Allah tells us that those whom He chose among His servants, those who inherited the Book which was revealed from the Lord of the worlds, will, on the Day of Resurrection, have an abode in Everlasting Gardens which they will enter on the Day when they are raised anew and meet Allah. ^ yi . ^ #/> v yjrj Cfi 4therein will they be adorned with bracelets ofgold and pearls,} It was recorded in the Sahth from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah% said: u & "The ornaments of the believer will reach as far as his Wudu'jW 4and their garments therein will be of silk.} For this reason it is forbidden for them (the males) in this world, but Allah will permit it for them in the Hereafter. It was recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah0 said: Jt Jip iJ *1Whoever wears silk in this world, will not wear it in the Hereafter. 111 Muslim 1:219. ^ Fath Al-Bari 10 :296. This applies only to males.

Silrah 35. Fdtir (36 - 37) (Part-22) 153 neither their bodies nor their souls will become exhausted; and Allah knows best. They used to exhaust themselves in worshipping this world, but their obligations will come to an end when they enter Paradise, where they will enjoy eternal rest and repose. Allah says: 4:< ijti) ^ 223 l iEat and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!} (69:24) Z' - . >' >?'> ' *> . *1 VV j^+»- cj|-uL»r tfjj' jjc L>vLu^ 14, 'H, oUjiu a&£ Jijlt a^ ^ J.- 436. But those who disbelieve, for them will be the fire of Hell. Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die nor shall its torment be lightened for them. Thus do I've requite every disbeliever !} 437. Therein they will cry : "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not that we used to do." (Allah will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the warmer came to you . So taste you . For the wrongdoers there is no helper."} ThePunishmentofthe DisbelieverandwhatTheirState willbe in Hell Having told us how the blessed will be (in Paradise), Allah now starts to tell us what the state ofdoomed will be. He says: x\ tVI4) .^ - n .lA 1 -V»ili 4But those who disbelieve, for them will be the fire of Hell. Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die} This is like the Ayah: £& •*> 4VVherein he will neither die nor live} (20:74).

iThus do We requite every disbeliever!} meaning, this is the recompense of everyone who disbelieved in his Lord and denied the truth. ^Therein they will cry means, they will call out in the Fire, beseeching Allah with their voices: ife ^z jii 'c; i“Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not that we used to do.”} which means, they will ask to go back to the worldly life so that they can do something different to the first deeds they did. But Allah, may He be glorified, knows that if He sent them back to this world, they would go back to what they had been forbidden to do, and He knows that they are lying, so He will not respond to their plea. This is like the Ayah where Allah tells us that they will say: iThen is there any way to get out (of the Fire). (It ivill be said) : “This is because, when Allah Alone was invoked you disbelieved (denied), but when partners were joined to Him, you believed!} (40:11,12) i.e., There will be no response for you because you were like that; if you were to return to this world, you would just go back to that which you had been forbidden to do.’ Allah says here: iDid We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you.} meaning, ‘did you not live for long enough in the world that if you were to be among those who would benefit from the truth, you would have benefited from it during your lifetimes?’ Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet% said:

Jill UZf jUJ Jr-? iff oll>-l xS- ^1 Lif <uj jJlpf jUJ> *-3} <iil Jtij t <1JJ IaJ «Allah has left no excusefor the person who lives to be sixty or seventy years old ; Allah has left no excuse for him; Allah has left no excusefor him. Imam Al-Bukhari also recorded, in the Book of Riqaq in his Sahih, that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said: Jr-? jff. ^ tijf Ji J*-j 3 «Allah has left no excuse for a man who reaches the age of sixty .n”*21 Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah said: * !_*?4 -Aii JU: Jii J «Whoever is granted a long life until the age of sixty, Allah has left no excusefor /lim.s ”*31 This was also recorded by Imam Ahmad and An-Nasal in Ar- Riqaq.W Because this is the age at which Allah removes any excuse from His servants, this is the usual age of people in this Ummah, as was reported in the Hadith of Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, who said, “The Messenger of Allah said: " Jf>i J* (*- £“*J JI 65 is osif 'Uii, iThe usual life span in my Ummah is between sixty and seventy years, and only afew pass this age.o” This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah in the Book ofZuhd [of his Simon).15 ’ 111 Ahmad 2:275. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :243 At-Tabari 20:478. ’4 ’ Ahmad 2:417, TuhfatAl-Ashraf9A72 ’5 ’ At-Tirmdhi no. 3550, Ibn Majah no. 4236.

257Surah 35. Fatir (36 - 37) (Part-22) 4And the wamer came to you.} It was reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, ‘Ikrimah, Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, may Allah be pleased with him, Qatadah and Sufyan bin ‘Uyaynah said, “This means grey hair.”111 As-Suddi and ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “This means the Messenger of Allah jfe” and Ibn Zayd recited, jxii js, 4This is a wamerofthe (series of) wamers ofold.} (53:56). This is the correct view according to Shayban who narrated that Qatadah said, “Proof will be established against them by the fact that they lived long enough and that Messengers came to them.”131 This is also the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and it is the apparent meaning of the Ayah: \$4 j\$8S1 JZL. A x jfi 4And they will cry (to the keeper of Hell): "O Malik! Let your Lord make an end of us." He will say : "Verily, you shall abide forever." Indeed We have brought the truth to you, but most of you have a hatredfor the truth.>(43:77-78) meaning: ‘We showed you the truth clearly through the Messengers, butyou rejected it and opposed it.’And Allah

says: 4AndWe neverpunish untilWehavesentaMessenger (17:15). c Ub uiS% m £ iju A ii '£> pt Q 'J\ '&} 4Every time a group is cast therein, its keepers will ask: "Did no wamer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer did come to us, but we denied him and said: 'Allah never sent down anything; you are only in great error'."} (67:8-9). ot Li \j>jjj} 111 Al-Baghawi 3 :573 At-Tabari 20 :478 131 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7:32.

159Surah 35. Fdtir (39 - 40) (Part-22) iHe it is Who has made you successors generations after generations in the earth,} meaning, all people succeed one another, generation after generation. This is like the Ayah: iand makes you inheritors of the earth, generations after generations {27:62}. 4*£&&S 4so whosoever disbelieves, on him will be his disbelief.} means, he and no one else will have to bear the consequences of that. iAnd the disbeliefof the disbelievers adds nothing but hatred of their Lord.} means, the longer they persist in their disbelief, the more Allah hates them, and the longer they persist in it, the more they and their families will lose on the Day of Resurrection. This is in contrast to the believers, for the longer they live and do good deeds, the higher their status in Paradise will be, the greater their reward, and the more beloved they will be to their Creator. Umj S. jvf* 1~T ^ ol U'j odJ 'ijy <jl cfyddh 4\$;& Cx.\$ Ail If, 440. Say: "Have you considered your partners whom you call upon besides Allah? Show Me, what they have created of the earth. Or have they any share in the heavens? Or have We given them a Book, so that they act on clear proof therefrom? Nay, the wrongdoers promise one another nothing but delusions."} 441. Verily, Allah grasps the heavens and the earth lest they should move away from their places, and if they xoere to move

VI jc £u u' 4He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave} (22:65), and }And among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command} (30:25). 'Ji fJ ot ul, Ub j dj} iand if tley were to move away from their places, there is not one that could grasp them after Him.} means, no one can make them stay and preserve them except Him. He is Ever Most Forbearing and Oft-Forgiving because He sees His servants disbelieving in Him and disobeying Him, yet He is patient and gives them time, He waits and does not hasten the punishment, and He conceals the faults of others and forgives them. He says: >y* Qf- {Truly, He is Ever Most Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.} pi tjQ at j-y |C-pJ j|^>- \fjif,} i \jp^ Sd % j jfji a y ps &% y ci-J Jj VjJ-? y oib JjC jii C/Sjfi C*IL V 442. And they swore by Allah their most bindirtg oath that ifa ivamer came to them, they would be more guided than any of the nations; yet what a wamer came to them, it increased in than nothing butflight (from the truth).} {43. (They took to flight because of their) arrogance in the land and their plotting of evil. But the evil plot encompasses only him who makes it. Then, can they expect anything (else) but the Sunnah (way of dealing) of the peoples of old? So, no change will you find in Allah's Sunnah, and no himing offwill you find in Allah's Sunnah.}

163Surah 35. Fatir (42 - 43) (Part-22) means, they only increased in their disbelief. Then Allah explains this further: i(They took to flight because of their) arrogance in the land} means, they were too arrogant to follow the signs of Allah. iand their plotting of evil.} means, they plotted to prevent people from following the path ofAllah. iBut the evil plot encompasses only him who makes it means, the evil consequences of that will come back upon them and not on others. iThen, can they expect anything (else) but the Sunnah (way of dealing) of the peoples ofold?} meaning, the punishment of Allah for disbelieving in His Messengers and going against His command. iand no turning offwill you find in

Allah's Sunnah .} means, it does not change or alter, and this is what happens to every disbeliever. iand no turning offwill you find in Allah's Sunnah.} means, ij* ill iBut when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning back of it} (13:11). This means, no one can remove that from them or ward it off from them. And Allah knows best. >/ / if* 3ff irfjfi

164 Tafsir Ibtt Kathlr ia - 444. Hflue they not traveled in the land, and seen what was the end of those before them - though they were super- ior to them in power Allah is not such that anything in the heavens or in the earth escapes Him. Verily, He is All- Knowing, All-Able.> 445. And if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned. He would not leave a mov- ing creature on the sur- face of the earth ; but He gives them respite to an appointed term, and when their term comes, then verily, Allah is Ever All-Seer of His Remember the Bad Consequences ofdisbelieving in the Prophets Allah says: ‘say, O Muhammad, to these people who disbelieve the Message you have brought: travel in the land and see what was the punishment of those who disbelieved the Messengers,

how Allah destroyed them completely, and a similar (end awaits)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4752–4753]

the disbelievers. See how their homes were emptied ofthem and how they lost everything after living in luxury and being so numerous and so well equipped, and having so much wealth and so many children. All of that was ofno avail to them and could not protect them in the slightest from the punishment of Allah when the command of the Lord came. Nothing is impossible for u&m it- ^j>-y.o^==4j ot jja 'mm fire ,-C^ > ' it >? . iCri rr -1 ^p-fJul J J * 'rrt- -r ^ s> S . -i * t servants .>

HimwhenHewants it to happen in the heavens oron earth.’ &\ft iVerily, He is All-Knowing, All-Ableft means, He knows all that exists and is able to do all things. TheWisdom behind delaying the Punishment Then Allah says: 4}£Z *4 Jidlf& if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earthft meaning, if He were to punish them for all of their sins, He would destroy all the people of the earth and all that they own of livestock and crops. Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi commented on the Ayah: 4&Z Cxi 4He would not leave a moving creature on the surface ofthe earthft “This means, He would have stopped sending rain to them, and all the animals would have died as a result.” ibut He gives them respite to an appointed termft means, but He is delaying until the Day of Resurrection, when He will bring them to account and will reward or punish each one according to his deeds: He will reward those who obeyed Him and will punish those who disobeyed Him. He says: cX Si'^ iand when their term comes, then verily, Allah is Ever All- Seer ofHis servantsft

Surah 36: Ya-Sin

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4754]

Opening Surah 36, Yd Sin (1 - 7) (Part-22) 167 The Tafslr of Surah Yd Sin (Chapter - 36)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4754–4765]

The Virtues of Surah Yd Sin Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said: jU-oJl Ljj 'JX 'y yj i«J by** j. j-i '3* 'a «Whoever recites Ya Sm in the night, will wake up forgiven, and ivhoever recites Ha Mim in which Ad-Dukhan (the Smoke) is mentioned, will wake up forgiven.» Its chain of narration is good (Jayyid) Ibn Hibban recorded in his Sahih that Jundub bin ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah jte said: • aJ 'yi- Ji-j y- <il yrj jlJ '3* y° ^Whoever recites Yd Sin in the night, seeking the Face of Allah, will be forgiven 2] In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. H <4 CP**# •r •>*" * J/t V'ff J/ ^ £. < > >r>,' ' , { Tj ' . *| f 1'- I'l Musnad Abi Ya’la, 11 :93. These two narrations are not authentic. As for Ibn Kathlr saying that the chain from Abu Hurayrah is good it is narrated by him from Al-Hasan, which is a link that is not verified by the scholars of Hadith. So Ibn Hajar (At-Taqrib) said, “Al- Hasan did not hear from Abu Hurayrah.” Perhaps Ibn Kathlr was of the opinion that it was possible that he did Ibn Hibban 4:121.

168 Tafsir IbtI Kathir il. Yd Sin .} 42. By the Qur'an, full of wisdom,} 43. Trtdy, you are one of the Messengers,} 44. On the straight path.} 45. Sent down by the Almighty, the Most Merciful,} 46. In order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not wanted, so they are heedless 47. Indeed the Word has proved true against most of them, so they will not believe.} The Messenger jg was sent as a Warner We have already discussed the individual letters at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. J-%} 4By the Qur'an, fill of wisdom} means, Al-Muhkam (perfect) which falsehood cannot come to from before it or behind it. 4Truly, you} means, O Muhammad, 4are one of the Messengers, on the straight path.} means, following a straight methodology and religion, and an upright Law. 4Sent down by the Almighty, the Most Merciful.} means, this path which you have brought is a revelation from the Lord of might Who is Most Merciful to His believing servants. This is like the Ayah: 4 bj vj1*—1' 4 b A ljj} 4 <'f 'A 4And verily, tjou are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight ' See Surah Fussilat 4 1 :42

169 Surah 36. Yd Sin (8 - 12) (Part-22) path . The path of Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth . Verily, to Allah all matters return .} (42:52-53). iln order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, so they are heedless.} This refers to the Arabs,

for no wamer had come to them before him. The fact that they alone are mentioned does not mean that others are excluded, just as mentioning some individuals does not mean that all others are excluded. We have already mentioned the Ayat and Mutawatir Hadiths which state that the mission of the Prophet is universal, when we discussed the meaning of the Ayah u s r-lill 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah." (7:158). iIndeed the Word has proved true against most of them,} Ibn Jarir said, "The punishment has become inevitable for most of them, because Allah has decreed in the Mother of the Book (Al-Lawh Al-Mahfu\$ that they will not believe. V& iso they will not believe.} in Allah, or in His Messengers. 11 ' (*+* tjtetiVl ,, J) iil ^ (Lr &[] •t A > •* •>< . ,rr - - ,<^ji s' Jyj 't'itrfe. J (*-4-* s~Y&~ <1£ 'a— <•;" "•'» '--'if '> ^,r "-r - >•*. s •> JI/-***i 'r~eih j-'V ,>• *? . "I 'it -s'.i" " i*!r *>. »•? 18. Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up.} 19. And We have put a barrier before them, and a barrier At-Tabari 20 :492

behind them, and We have covered them up, so that they cannot see. 410. It is the same to them whether you warn them or you warn than not, they will not believe. 411- You can only warn him who follows the Reminder, and fears the Most Gracious unseen . Bear you to such one the glad tidings offorgiveness, and a generous reward.4 412. Verily, We give life to the dead, and We record that which they send before (than), and their traces and all things We have recorded with numbers in Imam Mubin (a Clear Book). The State of Those Who are decreed to be among the Doomed Allah says: In the case of those who are decreed to be among the doomed, when it comes to the matter of being guided, We have made them like a person who has a chain around his neck and whose hands are tied together beneath his chin so that his head is lifted up.' As Allah says: ioJ^S) ^4 iso that their heads are raised up.} Mentioning the chains around the neck is sufficient and there is no need to mention the hands, although they are referred to by implication. Al-'Awfi said, narrating from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, concerning the Ayah: 4Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up. This is like the Ayah til 4And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck4(17:29). meaning that their hands are tied to their necks and they cannot stretch them forth in order to do any good deedsJ m At-Tabari 20 :494

iso that their heads are raised up.} according to Mujahid it means their heads are raised, and their hands are placed over their mouths,111 so they are restrained from doing anything good. St iAnd We have put a barrier before than,} Mujahid said, "Between them and the truth." iand a barrier behind than,} Mujahid said, "Between them and the truth, so they are confused."121 Qatadah said, "They move from one form ofmisguidance to another. iand We have covered than up,} means, *We have blinded their eyes to the truth.' iso that they cannot see.} means, they cannot benefit from goodness or be guided to it. Ibn Jarir said, "It was narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that he used to recite "Fa a'shaynahum" [instead ofFa'aghshaynahum], from Al-'Asha (weakness of the sight, blindness), which is a complaint of the eye."141 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, "Allah placed this barrier between them and Islam and Iman, so that they will never reach it," and he recited: iTruely, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97). m At-Jabari 20:494. AMabari 20:495. At-Tabari 20:495. Hl At-Jabari 20:496.

sees him except Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, he knows that Allah is watching him and sees what he does. y •*’ iBearyou to such one theglad tidings offorgiveness,\$ i.e., of his sins, * " s iand a generous reward.} means, one that is vast and great and beautiful. This is like the Ayah: *£> & iVerily, those who fear their Lord unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.} (67:12). iVerily, We give life to the dead,} means, on the Day of Resurrection. This also indicates that Allah gives life to the heart ofwhomever He wills among the disbelievers, those whose hearts have died in misguidance, by guiding them after that to the truth. As Allah says after mentioning hardness of the heart: i&i&Zp2 p% 1 SZ j\$f£& %2X} iKnow that Allah gives life to the earth after its death! Indeed We have made clear the Ayat to you, that you may understand.} (57 :17) iand We record that which they send before (them),} means, their deeds. iand their traces} means, We write down the deeds which they used to do themselves, and. the legacy they left behind, so We will requite them for that: if it is good, then We will reward them, and if it is evil, then We will punish them.’ This is like the Hadith: Ir! i’tZ lr! '4: J** j* ‘ 1^ Cf! 'j' fA

: f ,Lr- 0- Jl Ji i4*! ir! Jy^ jjjj “VV/ioeuer starts (or sets an example of) something good in Islam, will have a reward for it, and a reward equal to that of everyone who does it after him, without that detracting from their reward in the slightest. \Nhoeuer starts (or sets an example of) something evil in Islam, will bear the burden for that, and a burden equal to that ofeveryone who does it after him, without that detractingfrom their burden in the slightest. This was recorded by Muslim from Jarir bin ‘Abdullah Al- Bajali, may Allah be pleased with him in which is detailed a story of the people from the Mudar tribe, who were wearing woollen rags . 1 ’ 1 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this Hadith in full from Jarir bin ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him. In it the Prophet jg then recited: \yl C 4and We record that which they send before (them), and their traces> Muslim also recorded it with a different chain of narration . There is also another Hadith recorded in Sahih Muslim from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, who said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said: nWhen the son of Adam dies, all his deeds come to an end except three: knowledge which is beneficial to others, a righteous child who prays for him, or ongoing charity which he leaves behind, l>”13, Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that Abu Said said, “I heard Mujahid say concerning the Ayah: *** Muslim 2:704. Muslim 2:706. See no. 2353 in the Book of Zahah, which is the chain of narrators Ibn Kathir is referring to . The Ayah in question is redted in the Hadith recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim in explanation of this Ayah, not the version ofMuslim. Muslim 3:1255.

£2 C op' Pi i5i> 4Verily, We give life to the dead, and We record that which they send before (them), and their traces “What they left behind of misguidance.’ ” Ibn Abi Najih and others said, narrating from Mujahid: ithat which they send before (them),} “Their deeds.” iand their traces}. He said, “Their footsteps.” 111 This was also the view ofAl-Hasan and Qatadah. iand their traces} means their footsteps. 121 Qatadah said, “If Allah were to have neglected anything with regard to you, O son of Adam, He would have neglected what the wind could remove of these footsteps.”*3 * But He takes into account the footsteps of the son of Adam and all his deeds; He even takes into account these footsteps and whether they are for the purpose of obeying Allah or disobeying Him. So, whoever can have his footsteps recorded for the purpose of obeying Allah, let him do that. Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “There was an empty area around the Masjid, and Banu Salamah wanted to move to be closer to the Masjid. When the Messenger of Allah \$|§ heard about

that, he said to them: «J have heard that you want to move close to the Masjid.» They said, Yes, O Messenger of Allah, that is what we want.’ He sg said: 111 At-Tabari 20 :497 121 At-Tabari 20 :499 131 At-Tabari 20:499.

‘(J& disj !ia_ ^ u;» •0 Barn/ Salamah, stay where you are, and your footsteps will be recorded, stay where you are, and your footsteps will be recordedy* 1] This was also recorded by Muslim from Jabir, may Allah be pleased with him.*21 Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “A man died in Al-Madinah and the Prophet sg prayed over him, and said, Jj- j>oU iid U vWould that he had died somewhere other than in his place of birth! A man among the people said, “Why, O Messenger of Allah?”The Messenger ofAllah^ said: *5^' <-4 ilrf ^ J jj» «kWi#i a man dies somewhere other than in his place of birth, it will be measured for him from where he was bom to where his footsteps no longer appear, (and this is the space that will be allocatedfor him) in Paradise.s”131 It was also recorded by An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.141 Ibn Jarir narrated that Thabit said, “I was walking with Anas and I began to walk quickly. He took my hand and we walked slowly, and when we had finished praying, Anas said, ‘I walked with Zayd bin Thabit and I was walking quickly, and he said: O Anas! Do you not feel that your footsteps are being written down?’ ”|s| There is no contradiction between this and the first report, on the contrary, this indicates the same thing somewhat more forcefully. Because these footsteps are being recorded, then those which are setting an example, whether good or bad, are Ahmad 3:332. Muslim 1 :462 •3| Ahmad 2:177. An-Nasal 4 :7, Ibn Majah 1 : 515 At-Tabari 20 :498

Jr U\ z&m'® Si Gjyi_isyjLiili^*3L«_to)JjSo il Ijl^rUoLjjy 0<^~^5 <yi^T0 W(i?ilj<5^ csiljlx.1 0jJS4% <z4jjijoj-Aaf-t*•> •.^ i . <«&, i ,<' ,1(<i ' , rfS>> > - j-s\$ more likely to be recorded. And Allah knows best. M ti iand all things We have recorded with numbers (as a record) in Imam Mubin (a Clear Book).} means, everything that exists is precisely dictated in a record in Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz. Al-Imam Al-Mubin here refers to the source of all records. This was the view of Mujahid, Qatadah and ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.l * Similarly, Allah also says: <f& 3^=* (JiY i(And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam (record ofgood and bad deeds)} (17:71). meaning the Book of their deeds which will testify as to their deeds, whether they were good or bad. This is like the Ayat y£\ \jefi}’ iand the Book will be placed (open), and the Prophets and the witnesses will be broughtforward} (39:69), and Ua i)U \il^i ({/i £*?of} 111 At-Tabari 20 :499

178 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4 ‘ML* V> jjL*- £ lfUaa-1 V) ijijf V, Ujj Je£ iAnd the Book (one's Record) will be placed, and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is (recorded) therein. They will say : "Woe to us! What sort of Book is this that leaves neither a small thing nor a big thing, but has recorded it with numbers!" And they will find all that they did, placed before them, and your Lord treats no one with injustice.} (18:49). L-ajfiSo Ojjf ULJI jjr" U«U- 3) A fi ^ir^ij} « \$ Ej vip z ijii p&i \ 5uS cfjii, ip giT VI c; VI £1 4 *£ ^'x'oa-D' ^13. And putforward to them a similitude; the Dwellers of the Town, when there came Messengers to them.} 414. When We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both; so We reinforced titem with a third, and they said: "Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers."} 415. They said: "You are only human beings like ourselves, and the Most Gracious has revealed nothing. You are only telling lies."} 416. The Messengers said: "Our Lord knows that we have been sent as Messengers to you,"} 417. "And our duty is only to convey plainly."}

The Story of the Dwellers of the Town and Their

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4765–4816]

Messengers, a Lesson that Those Who belied Their Messengers were destroyed Allah says, ‘O Muhammad, tell your people who disbelieve in you,’ 4&.p 3i i\$& } 4a similitude; the Dwellers of the Town, when there came Messengers to them.} In the reports that he transmitted from Ibn ‘Abbas, Ka*b Al- Ahbar and Wahb bin Munabbih - Ibn Ishaq reported that it was the city of Antioch, in which there was a king called

Antiochus the son of Antiochus the son of Antiochus, who used to worship idols. Allah sent to him three Messengers, whose names were Sadiq, Saduq and Shalum, and he disbelieved in them.’ ’ It was also narrated from Buraydah bin Al-Husayb, ‘Ikrimah, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri that it was Antioch. 121 Some of the Imams were not sure that it was Antioch, as we shall see below after telling the rest of the story, if Allah wills. 4zijS&&\$ny& 4When We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both;} means, they hastened to disbelieve in them. 4so We reinforced them with a third,} means, *We supported and strengthened them with a third Messenger.’ Ibn Jurayj narrated from Wahb bin Sulayman, from Shu’ayb Al-Jaba’i, “The names of the first two Messengers were Sham’an and Yuhanna, and the name of the third was Bulus, and the city was Antioch (Antakiyah). iand they said} means, to the people of that city, 4Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers.} meaning, ‘from your Lord Who created you and Who commands you to worship Him Alone with no partners or associates.’ This was the view of Abu Al-‘Aliyah. Qatadah bin Di’amah claimed that they were messengers of the Messiah, peace be upon him, sent to the people of Antioch. % VJ Z>» iThey said: “You are only human beings like ourselves...”} means, ‘so how could you receive revelation when you are 111 At-Tabari 20:500. 121 At-Tabari 20:500.

lying, He would have taken the utmost vengeance against us, but He will cause us to prevail and will make us victorious against you, and you will come to know whose will be the happy end in the Hereafter.” This is like the Ayah: l£*» J £ Si - 'S »J' (*-* jilj ==») 4Say: “Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. He btows what is in the heavens and on earth.” And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers .} (29:52) IS Uj> 4And our duty is only to convey plainly.} means, ‘all we have to do is to convey to you the Message with which we have been sent; if you obey, then happiness will be yours in this world and the Hereafter, and if you do not respond, you will soon know the consequences of that.’ And Allah knows best. •*. **? ?•>' t Tt<-« 418. They (people) said : “For us, we see an evil omen from you ; if you cease not, we will surely stone you, and a painfid torment will touch youfrom us.”} 419. They (Messengers) said: “Your evil omens be with you! Because you are admonished? Nay, but you are a people mischievous.”} Then the people of the city said to them, 4For us, we see an evil omen from you;} meaning, *we do not see in your faces any sign of good for our lives.’ Qatadah said, “They were saying, “if something bad befalls us, it will be because of you.’ ”,l) Mujahid said, “They were saying: People like you never enter a town, but its people are punished.” m At-Tabari 20 :502

<& 4/ you cease not, we will surely stone you,} Qatadah said, “By throwing stones at you.”111 ifr it: iand a painful torment will touch youfrom us.} means, a severe punishment. Their Messengers said to

them: \$Your evil omens be with you!} meaning, they are thrown back at you.’ This is like the Ayah where Allah describes the people of Fir‘awn: Vt ,11:£ *-l— U ijlii a;X\ Hj.ll liji^ 4}i' is 4Bwf whenever good came to them, they said: "Ours is this." And if evil afflicted than, they ascribed it to evil omens connected with Musa and those with him. Be informed! Verily, their evil omens are with Allah (7:131). And the people of Salih said: 4<i' i* JS 4"We augur ill omen from you and those with you.” He said: “Your ill omen is with Allah.”} (27:47) And Allah said: :£ V » *>. > \\\s J* bt (^4^ Oi^ ^ ^ *>/ i 4A«d i/ some good reaches them, they say, "This is from Allah," but if some evil befalls than, they say, "This is from you." Say: "All things arefrom Allah," so what is wrong with these people that theyfail to understand any word?} (4:78) 4oArli (J j? 0\$) i(Do you call it "evil omen") because you are admonished? At-Tabari 20 :502

Nay, but you are a people mischievous.} means, ‘because of us, because we admonished you and told you to worship Allah Alone and with all sincerity, and in return you said what you said and threatened us. Nay, but you are a mischievous people.’ Qatadah said, “This means, “Because we reminded you about Allah, you saw an evil omen in us. Nay, but you are a mischievous people’.” Ot lai L\$jjl -Ufrl V • t Kk " i <*' iT "*" >*>»h • > . */ 1 1" X* 0-*> V _r^» 6^y‘ o[4 i! jiu 420. And there came a man running from the farthest part of the town. He said, “O my people! Obey the Messengers.”} 421 . "Obey those who ask no wages of you, and who are rightly guided."} 422. "And why should I not worship Him Who has created me and to Whom you shall be returned."} 423. "Shall I take besides Him gods? If the Most Gracious intends me any harm, their intercession will be ofno usefor me whatsoever, nor can they save me."} 424. "Then verily, I should be in plain error."} 425. "Verily, I have believed in your Lord, so listen to me!"} Quoting what reached him from Ibn ‘Abbas, Ka*b Al-Ahbar and Wahb bin Munabbih - Ibn Ishaq reported that, “The people of the city resolved to kill their Messengers, then a man came running to them from the farthest part of the town, i.e., to help them against his people. They said, his name was Habib, and he used to work with ropes. He was a sickly man who suffered from leprosy, and he was very charitable, giving half of his earnings in charity, and his Fitrah (natural inclination) was sound. ”*2 * Shabib bin Bishr said, narrating from ‘Ikrimah, from Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that the name of the man mentioned in Yd Sin was Habib An-Najjar, At-Tabari 20:504. •2| At-Tabari 20:504.

and he was killed by his people. faj iHe said: “O my people 1 . Obey the Messengers ’> - he urged his people to follow the Messengers who had come to them. 40£& v * \Jt) iObey those who ask no wages of you,) means, Tor the Message which they convey to you, and they are rightly-guided in what they are calling you to, the worship of Allah Alone with no partner or associate.’ 4SJ& ilcl v 3, 4And why should I not worship Him Who has created me) means, ‘and what is there to stop me from sincerely worshipping the One Who has created me, and worshipping Him Alone, with no partner or associate?’ iand to Whom you shall be returned.) means, ‘on the Day of Resurrection, when He will requite you for your deeds: if they are good then you will be rewarded and if they are evil then you will be punished.’ 4*^f at 4Shall I take besides Him gods?) This is a rhetorical question intended to rebuke and chastise. j . >. . * ./x -ri Ur" ^ ji. CjJJ,^ 4If the Most Gracious intends me any harm, their intercession will be ofno usefar me whatsoever, nor can they save me.) means, These gods whom you worship instead of Him possess no power whatsoever, if Allah wills me some harm,’ 4% VJ. /<! •%) 4none can remove it but

He) (6:17). These idols can neither cause any harm nor bring any benefit, and they cannot save me from the predicament I am in.'

iThen verily, I should be in plain error.^ means, 'if I were to take them as gods instead of Allah.' iVerily, I have believed in your Lord, so listen to me!} Ibn Ishaq said, quoting from what had reached him from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Ka*b and Wahb, "He said to his people: i'Veerily, I have believed in your Lord} in Whom you have disbelieved, iso listen to me!}' means, listen to what I say."111 Or it may be that he was addressing the Messengers when he said: rAl^l iVerily, I have believed in your Lord,} meaning, Who has sent you,' iso listen to me!} meaning, *bear witness to that before Him.' This was narrated by Ibn Jarir, who said, "And others said that this was addressed to the Messengers, and he said to them: *Listen to what I say and bear witness to what I say before my Lord, that I have believed in your Lord and have followed you.' This interpretation is more apparent, and Allah knows best. Ibn Ishaq said, quoting from what had reached him from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Ka*b and Wahb, When he said that, they turned on him as one, and killed him at once, and he had no one to protect him from that.'"121 Qatadah said, "They started to stone him while he was saying, 'O Allah, guide my people for they do not know, and they kept stoning him until he died a violent death, and he was still praying for At-Jabari 20:507. At-Tabari 20:508.

them.' May Allah have mercy on him." <jj> 2# djfr , *I" Uj J Uj tj ® oj^ ui •;:**» Jt *Ay» Uj*1 4#4^ S' Uj .13? 3; |^t ^j Is aJ^j 4*^,^, ^1 1 -i > ' * "T 4,^,JJ.U1*. 426 . It was said: "Enter Paradise." He said: "Would that my people knew."} 427 . "That my Lord (Allah) has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!"} 428. And We sent not against his people after him an army from the heaven, nor was it need- ful for Us to said (such a thing).} 429. It ivas but one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from some of his companions from Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, that they stamped on him until his intestines came out of his back passage. Allah said to him: 4%l i"Enter Paradise."} so he entered it with all its bountiful provision, when Allah had taken away from him all the sickness, griefand exhaustion of this world. 2) Mujahid said, "It 111 At-Tabari 20:501. 121 At-Tabari 20 :508

was said to Habib An-Najjar, "Enter Paradise.' This was his right, for he had been killed. When he saw the reward, 4He said: "Would tlwt my people knew Qatadah said, "You will never find a believer but he is sincere and is never insincere. When he saw with his own eyes how Allah had honored him, he said: ot <X> J jj* <j 4He said: "Would that my people knew that my Lord has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!"} He wished that his people could know about what he was seeing with his own eyes of the honor of Allah."12 * Ibn 'Abbas said, "He was sincere towards his people during his lifetime by saying, 40 my people! Obey the Messerigers} , and after his death by saying: iWould that my people knew that my Lord (Allah) has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!} This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from 'Asim Al-Ahwal from Abu Mijlaz: 4 <jj j ju- &} 4That my Lord has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!} "Because of my faith in my Lord and my belief in the Messengers." He meant that if they could see the great reward and everlasting blessings that he had attained, this would lead them to follow the Messengers. May Allah have mercy on him and be pleased with him, for he was so keen that his people should be guided. ^ iLJi <ja cy, j* i>j} At-Tabari 20:509. At-Tabari 20 :509

people sifter they killed him, it was but one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still} Ibn Jarir said, "The former view is more correct, because the Message does not need to be brought by an army."*2 * The scholars of Tafsir said, "Allah sent Jibril, peace be upon him, to them, and he seized the pillars at the gate of their city, then he hurled one Sayhah upon them and lo! they (all) were still, to the last man among them, and no soul was left in any body." We have already referred to the reports from many of the Salaf that this city was Antioch, and that these three Messengers were messengers sent from the Messiah "Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, as Qatadah and others stated. This is not mentioned by any of the later scholars of Tafsir besides him, and this issue must be examined from a number of angles. (The first) is that if we take this story at face value, it indicates that these men were Messengers from Allah, may He be glorified, not from the Messiah, peace be upon him, as Allah says: iWhen We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both; so We reinforced them with a third, and they said: "Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers."} up to: gif% Cj ipjt# & i"Our Lord knows that we luroe been sent as Messengers to you. And our duty is only to convey plainly (the Message)." If they had been from among the Disciples, they would have said something to indicate that they had come from the Messiah, peace be upon him. And Allah knows best. Moreover, if they had been messengers sent by the Messiah, why would the people have said to them, Hi} 111 At-Tabari 20:510. 121 At-Tabari 20:511.

190 Tafstr Ibn Kathir i"You are only human beings like ourselves"^(The second) is that the people of Antioch did believe in the messengers sent by the Messiah to them. Antioch was the first city to believe in the Messiah, and it is one of the four cities in which there are Christian patriarchs. These cities are: Jerusalem, because it is the city of the Messiah; Antioch, because it was the first city where all of the people believed in the Messiah; Alexandria, because it was in that city that they agreed to reform the hierarchy of patriarchs, metropolitans (archbishops), bishops, priests, deacons and monks; and Rome, because it is the city of the Emperor Constantine who supported and helped to establish their religion. When he adopted Constantinople as his city, the Patriarch of Rome moved there, as has been mentioned by several historian, such as Said bin Batrfq and others, both People of the Book and Muslims. If we accept that, then the people of Antioch were the first to believe, but Allah tells us that the people of this town rejected His Messengers and that He destroyed them with one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still. And Allah knows best. (The third) is that the story of Antioch and the Disciples of the Messiah happened after the Tawrah had been revealed. Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, and others among the Salaf stated that after revealing the Tawrah, Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, did not destroy an entire nation by sending a punishment upon them. Rather, He commanded the believers to fight the idolators. They mentioned this when discussing the Ayah: iAtid indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations ofold - the Scripture (28:43). This implies that the city mentioned in the Qur'an is a city other than Antioch, as also stated by more than one of the Salaf. Or, ifwe wish to keep the same name, it is possible that it is another Antioch, not the one which is well-known, for it is not known that it (the famous Antioch) was destroyed, either during Christian times or before. And Allah knows best. && 'J iVi\$.aj \j& V] Jjij ^ JUAM

A*- £3 .X ^ (*t^j j2\$ <\$30. A/as /or mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} 431. Do they not see how many of the generations We have destroyed before than? Verily, they will not return to them.} 432. And surely, all - everyone of them will be brought before

Us.} Woe to the Disbelievers! ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the Ayah: 4Alas for mankind!}, this means, woe to mankind! 1 ‘ Qatadah said: 4Alas for mankind!} means, “Alas for mankind, who have neglected the command of Allah.”12’ The meaning is that they will feel regret and sorrow on the Day of Resurrection. When they see the punishment with their own eyes; they will regret how they disbelieved the Messengers of Allah and went against the commands of Allah, for they used to disbelieve in them in this world. o’ 4There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} means, they disbelieved him and made fun of him, and rejected the message of truth with which he had been sent. The Refutation of the Belief in the Transmigration of Souls Then Allah says: (4S&&S -M At-Tabari 20:512. 121 At-Tabari 20:512.

433. And a sign for them is the dead land. We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} 434. And We have made therein gardens of date palms and grapes, and We have caused springs of water to gush forth therein .} 435. So that they may eat of the fruit thereof- and their hands made it not. Will they not then give thanks?} 436. Glory be to Him Who has created all the pairs of that which the earth produces, as well as of their own kind, and of that which they know not.} Proof of the Creator of the Universe and of Life after Death Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, says: 4And a sign for them} means, evidence for them of the existence of the Creator and His perfect power and ability to resurrect the dead, 4/s the dead land.} means, when it is dead and arid, with no vegetation, then Allah sends water upon it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth). Allah says: 4#*-fc 4We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} meaning, “We have made it a provision for them and their cattle.’ iin’ O ..Ik It 1’. 4And We have made therein gardetts of date palms and grapes, and We have caused springs ofwater to gush forth therein.} means, *We have created therein rivers which flow to the places where they are needed, so that they may eat of their fruits.’ When Allah reminds them of the blessing that He bestows upon His creation by creating crops and plants, He

mentions the different types and kinds of fruits. Allah says: 4^j? iil* £j} iand their hands made it not.} means, all of that could only come about by the mercy of Allah towards them, not by their own efforts and labor and strength. This was the view of Ibn ‘Abbas and Qatadah. Allah says: iWitl they not then give thanks?} meaning, will they not then give thanks for the innumerable blessings that He has bestowed upon them. Ibn Jarir, however, understood the word Ma to mean Alladhi (i.e., a relative pronoun). In this case the meaning of the Ayah would be that they eat from the fruits provided by Allah’s bounty and from what their own hands have done, i.e., by planting the seeds and tending the plants. Ibn Jarir mentioned other possible interpretations in his Tafsir, but this is the interpretation that he favored. This interpretation also fits with the recitation of Ibn Mas‘ud: ^J J (So that they may eat of the fruit thereof- andfrom what their own hands have done.) Then Allah says: 4 U-j ulfe’ yU- cfjjf if>IL} iGlory he to Him Who has created all the pairs of that which the earth produces,} meaning, of crops and fruits and plants. if+jd If,} ias well as of their own (human) kind,} means, He made them into male and female. iand of that which they know not.} means, different kinds of creatures ofwhich they know nothing. This is like the Ayah: ffXb £rJL) LiIl J^==» oi

{And of everything We have created pairs, that you may remember (51:49) V Jj’—• <jjji yfj^ eft? Sf\$% & c5 'Q<g u^> 437. And <j sign /or them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the day, and behold, they

are in darkness.) 438. And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.^ 439. And the moon, We have decreed for it stages, till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. 440. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.) Among the Signs of the Might and Power of Allah are the Night and Day, and the Sun and Moon Allah tells us of further proof of His great might and power, which is His creation of the night and day, the one with its darkness and the other with its light. He has caused them to follow one another, so that one comes and the other goes, and so on, as He says: 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly (7:54). Allah says here: 4And a sign for them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the day,) meaning, *We take it away from it, so it goes away and the night comes.' Allah says: pi i and behold, they are in darkness .) As it says in the Hadith:

>ii iii JI I Ilf* 'y» j[£}\ jzVj t ll^A y* Jill Jjt til » ilA/hen the night comes from here, and the day departs from here, and the sun has set, then the fasting person should break his fast . This is the apparent meaning of the Ayah Allah's saying: LiO'j s',J iAnd the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing There are two views over the meaning of the phrase ion its fixed course for a term (appointed).} (The first view) is that it refers to its fixed course of location, which is beneath the Throne, beyond the earth in that direction. Wherever it goes, it is beneath the Throne, it and all of creation, because the Throne is the roof of creation and it is not a sphere as many astronomers claim. Rather it is a dome supported by legs or pillars, carried by the angels, and it is above the universe, above the heads of people. When the sun is at its zenith at noon, it is in its closest position to Throne, and when it runs in its fourth orbit at the opposite point to its zenith, at midnight, it is in its furthest position from the Throne. At that point it prostrates and asks for permission to rise, as mentioned in the Hadiths. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I was with the Prophet in the Masjid at sunset, and he said: aL, 'J6 y\ ^jj3\ ijid u» "O Abu Dharr! Do you know where the sun sets?*" I said, 'Allah and His Messenger know best.' He said: FathAl-Bari4:231

197Surah 36. Yd Sin (37 - 40) (Part-23 alt goes and prostrates beneath the Throne, and that is what Alldh says : iAnd the sun runs on its fixed course for a term That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing It was also reported that Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the Ayah iAnd the sun runs on its fixed course for a term.) He said: alts fixed course is beneath the Throne.s"12 (The second view) is that this refers to when the sun's appointed time comes to an end, which will be on the Day of Resurrection, when its fixed course will be abolished, it will come to a halt and it will be rolled up. This world will come to an end, and that will be the end of its appointed time. This is the fixed course of its time. Qatadah said: ion its fixed course for a term (appointed).} means, "It has an appointed time and it will not go beyond that."*31 It was also said that this means, it keeps moving in its summer orbit for a certain time, and it does not exceed that, then it moves to its winter orbit for a certain time, and it does not exceed that. This was narrated from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him. Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with them, recited this Ayah as: 0kJ (And the sun runs with no fixed course for a term,) meaning that it has no destination and it does not settle in one place, rather it keeps moving night and day, never slowing down or stopping, as in the Ayah: 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :402 121 FathAl-Bari 8:402. Al-Tabari 20:517.

198 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ^OHp He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses, to be of service to you} (14:33). which means, they will never slow down or stop, until the Day of Resurrection. ijffo jy iThat is the decree of the Almighty, means, which none oppose or prevent. can ithe All-Knowing Who knows every movement and every cessation of movement, Who has decreed that and Who has set it in motion following a pattern in which there are no differences or inversions, as Allah says: i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing (6:96) And this is how this Ayah ends: jrjfoi JXU iThat is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing> Then Allah says: iJfC isa iAnd the moon, We have decreed for it stages, meaning, *We have caused it to run in a different orbit, from which passing of the months can be deduced, just as night and day are known from the sun.' This is like the Ayah: JI 3* yfr iThey ask you about the crescent moons. Say: "These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind and for the pilgrimage (Hajj)."i[2:189), ffix, faf.% rcj j-m » ilt is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a

light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning> (10:5), and ,ji -L » Ajl* llLur} ,1^1 / rj> / * / > > / / t. / ? < / / * / // • > » / . V. i iAnd We have appointed the night and the day as two Ayat (signs). Then, We have obliterated the sign of the night while We have made the sign of the day illuminating, that you may seek bounty from your Lord, and that you may know the number of the years and the reckoning. And We have explained everything with full explanation . \$ (17:12) So, He has given the sun its own light, and the moon its (reflection of) light, and has given each its own orbit. So the sun rises each day and sets at the end of the day, giving one kind of light all the time, but it moves, rising and setting at different points in the summer and winter, thus making the days and nights longer or shorter alternatively according to the season. Its authority is in the daytime, for it is the heavenly body that dominates the day. As for the moon, Allah has decreed that it should pass through different phases. At the beginning of the month, the moon appears small when it rises. It gives off little light, then on the second night its light increases and it rises to a higher position, and the higher it rises the more light it gives - even though it is reflected from the sun - until it becomes full on the fourteenth night of the month. Then it starts to wane until the end of the month, until it appears like the old dried curved date stalk. Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "This is the original stem (which connects the bunch of dates to the tree)."111 The Arabs have a name for each set of three nights in a month, according to the phases of the moon. They call the first three nights Ghurar, the next three nights Nufab, the next three nights Tusa' (nine) - because the last of them is the ninth. The next three nights are called 'Ushar (ten) - because the first of them is the tenth. The next three nights are called Al-Bld (white) - because of the light of the moon which shines U1 At-Tabari 20 :518

200 Tafsir Ibn Kathir brightly throughout these three nights. The next three nights are called Dura', the plural of Dar'a', because on the first of them the night is dark from the moon rising late. Dar'a' refers to the black sheep, i.e., the one whose head is black; the next three nights Zulam; then Hanadis, then Da'adv, then Mihdq, because of the absence of moonlight at the beginning of the month. Abu TJBayd did not recognize the names Tusa' and 'Ushar, in the book Gharxb Al-Musannaf. ij^ iJ 1 li J.l * ! ' ilt is not for the sun to overtake the moon,) Mujahid said, "Each of them has a limit which it does not transgress or fall short of. When the time of one comes, the other goes away, and when the time for one to prevail comes, the time of the other ceases. Ikrimah said concerning the Ayah, j" U ilt is not for tire

sun to overtake the moon,) this means that each of them has its time when it prevails. So it is not appropriate for the sun to rise at night. 4c\$ inor does the night outstrip the day> means, after night has passed, it is not right for another night to come until it has been day. The authority of the sun is during the day and the authority of the moon is at night. Ad-Dahhak said, "The night does not depart from here until the day comes from here - and he pointed to the east." 21 Mujahid said: ij& Sf\$ inor does the night outstrip the day.) "They seek one another rapidly." 31 The meaning is that there is no gap between night and day; each of them follows the other with no interval, because they have been subjugated and are both constantly pursuing one another. At-Tabari 20:520. At-Tabari 20:520. At-Tabari 20:519.

J tisfes tir '***.* riv // S s* +>* ***"+ s /4Sv / *+ + % 1jJ__jtjp ;C'!3 itr-*^=sacjjJ'(pjiJJ1 ^ ^ . * > > ••«*?' *r ^ \ K" ^ *5 -f/ j. / '/'/Mif >i^i'A|>A-A»-u 0 4>u^ L : 4*:r H^aA) /" •^/ **^ Op -" .i.T- iThey all float, each in an orbit.} means, night and day, the sun and the moon, all of them are floating, i.e., revolving, in their orbits in the heaven. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and 'Ata' Al- Khurasani. Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others among the Salaf said, "In an orbit like the arc of a spinning wheel." 4 a p. Iff} fi bi£> yj&fi ^ ub ,? > oy~ty_ l- ot T«S*\$es dt 441 . And an Ayah for them is that We bore their offspring in the laden ship.} 442 . And We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride.} 443. And ifWe will, We shall drown them, and there will be no shoutfor them, nor will they be saved.} -* 444. Unless it be a mercyfrom Us, and as an enjoyment for a while.} hi At-Jabari 20 :520

refers to?" We said, "No." He said, "This refers to the ships which were made after the ship of Nuh, peace be upon him, which was similar to it." ' This was also the view of Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Abu Salih and As-Suddi, that the Ayah oi tdl-j} iAnd We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride.} refers to ships. 12 ' iAnd ifWe will. We shall drown them,} means, those who are on board the ships. iand there will be no shout for them} means, there will be no one to save them from their predicament. 'Jj} inor will they be saved.} means, from what has befallen them. it illnless it be a mercy from Us,} means, *but by Our mercy We make it easy for you to travel on land and sea, and We keep you safe until an appointed time.' Allah says: iand as an enjoyment for a while.} meaning, until a time that is known to Allah, may He be glorified and exalted. i45 . And when it is sdid to them : "Beware of that which is before you, and that which is behind you, in order that you may receive mercy."} 111 AMabari 20:523. At-Tabari 20:522-524.

204 Tafsir Ibn Kathlr 446. And never came an Ayah from among the Ayat of their Lord to them, but they did turn awayfrom it.} 447 . And when it is said to them: "Spend of that with which Allah has provided you," those who disbelieve say to those who believe: "Shall we feed those whom, if Allah willed, He would havefed? You are only in a plain error."} The Misguidance ofthe Idolators Allah tells us how the idolators persisted in their misguidance and in not paying attention to the sins that they had committed in the past or what was to happen to them in the future, on the Day of Resurrection. Ltf J}| U iyjt |vi Si 4And when it is said to them : "Fear of that which is before you, and that which is behind you..."} Mujahid said, "This refers to sins."Others said it is the opposite. 4&&} iin order that you may receive mercy.} means, 'so that, ifyou fear such things Allah will have mercy on you and will save you from His punishment.' The wording implies that they would not respond. Rather that they would turn away and ignore that, as Allah says: 4And never came an Ayah from among the Ayat of their Lord to them,}

meaning, signs of Tawhid and the truth of the Messengers, 4but they did turn away from it,} means, they did not accept it or benefit from it. lit 'fr Si 4And when it is said to them : "Spend of that with which Allah has provided you,"} means, when they are told to spend of that which Allah has provided to them on the poor and needy among the Muslims,

cJi iM ju4 itthose who disbelieve say to those who believe means, about the believers who are poor, i.e., they say to those believers who tell them to spend on the needy, ii' iui ji ^\$} iShall we feed those whom, if Allah willed, He (Himself) would have fed?} meaning, 'those whom you are telling us to spend on, if Allah had wanted to, He would have made them independent and fed them from His provision, so we are in accordance with the will of Allah with regard to them.' 4You are only in a plain error.} means, *by telling us to do that.' {' C -C'•' v?i f >1^ i" / •>V . *- 'u t'S // " \ Y. p-*) ii ^ .W13 CA>-J 1* ;^ Oft. "k'Jr' 448. And they say: "When will this promise be fulfilled, if you are truthful?"} 449. They await only but a single Sayhah which will seize them while they are disputing!} 450. Then they will not be able to make bequest, nor they will return to their family.} The Disbelievers thought that the Day of Resurrection would never come to pass Allah tells us how the disbelievers thought that the Day of Resurrection would never come to pass, as they said: 4)2\$ £.} 4"Wheti will this promise be fulfilled .. ."} ^ ^ 14 iThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it} (42:18). Allah says: ('A) -U-b aJ^j 1*4

454. This Day, none will be wronged in anything, nor will you be requited anything except that which you used to do. The Trumpet Blast of the Resurrection This will be the third blast of the trumpet^ ' the trumpet blast of the resurrection when people will come forth from their graves. Allah says: 4^>^i frej d[vWV'i 4and behold from the graves they will come out quickly to their Lord. Yansilun means they will be walking quickly. This is like the Ayah: C > • > J) 4The Day when they will come out of the graves quickly as racing to a goal. (70:43). iW 4They will say: "Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep."} meaning, their graves, which in this world they thought they would never be raised from. When they see with their own eyes that in which they had disbelieved, 4 iii b—" l> 4They will say: "Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep This does not contradict the fact that they will be punished in their graves, because in comparison to what is to come afterwards, that will seem like a nap. Ubayy bin Ka*b, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, "They will sleep before the Resurrection."*21 Qatadah See volume seven, the Tafsir of Surat An-Naml [27:87], The reference to the third blast is based upon a narration that is not authentic as explained there At-Tabari 20 :533

457. They will have therein fruits and all that they ask for 458. (It will be said to them) : "Salam (Peace!)" - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful The Life of the People of Paradise Allah tells us that on the Day of Resurrection, when the people of Paradise have reached the arena of judgement, and have settled in the gardens of Paradise, they will be too preoccupied with their own victory and new life of eternal delights to worry about anyone else. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said, "They will be too busy to think about the torment which the people of Hell are suffering. Mujahid said:

iwill be busy with joyful things> "With the delights which they are enjoying."111 This was also the view of Qatadah. Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "This means that they will be rejoicing." iThey and their wives> Mujahid said, "Their spouses, iwill be in pleasant shade,) means, in

the shade of trees.”¹²¹ reclining on thrones.) Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Ka‘b, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Khusayf said: (throne) means beds beneath canopies.¹³¹ (They will have therein fruits) means, of all kinds. (And all that they ask for.) means, whatever they ask for, they will find it, all kinds and types. (Salam (Peace!)) - a Word from the Lord (Allah), Most Merciful.) Ibn Jurayj said, “Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, concerning this Ayah, Allah Himself, Who is the Peace (As-Salam) will grant peace to the people of Paradise. This view of Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, is like the Ayah: At-Tabari 20:535. At-Tabari 20:538. At-Tabari 20:539, 540.

4 Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be “Salam” (33:44). (And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day.”} <60. “Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan? Verily, he is a plain enemy to you.”} <62. “And that you should worship Me. That is the straight path.”} <62. “And indeed he did lead astray a great multitude of you. Did you not then understand?”} The Isolation of the Disbelievers and Their Rebuke on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us what the end of the disbelievers will be on the Day of Resurrection, when He commands them to get apart from the believers, i.e., to stand apart from the believers. This is like the Ayat <And the Day whereon We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who did set partners in worship with Us : “Stop at your place! You and your partners.” Then We shall separate them} (10:28). (And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall they be separated.) (30:14) (On that Day they shall be divided} (30:43) which means, they will be divided into two separate groups. 43 -krt 51 & oj> jj

212 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4 (It will be said to the angels): “Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions and what they used to worship, instead of Allah, and lead them on to the way of flaming Fire (Hell).” (37:22-23). (Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan? Verily, he is a plain enemy to you.) This is a rebuke from Allah to the disbelievers among the sons of Adam, those who obey the Shaytan even though he was a plain enemy to them, and they disobeyed Ar-Rahman Who created them and granted them provision. Allah says: (And that you should worship Me. That is the straight path.) meaning, ‘I commanded you in the world to disobey the Shaytan, and I commanded you to worship Me, and this is the straight path, but you followed a different path and you followed the commands of the Shaytan.’ Allah says: (And indeed he did lead astray a great multitude of you.) meaning, a large number of people. This was the view of Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Sufyan bin Thayyab. (Did you not then understand?) means, ‘did you not have any understanding, when you went against the command of your Lord to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate, and you preferred to follow the Shaytan?’ & \$ & h\$ lijU ^) ^ its jfj\$&£ iX^ #SJ frJWJ & 163. This is Hell which you were promised!) 164. (Enter) therein this Day, for that you used to

213 Surah 36. (The disbelievers) (Part-23) disbelieve.} i65. This Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to earn.} 466. And if it had been Our will. We would surely have wiped out their eyes, so that they would struggle for the path, how then would they see?} 467. And if it had been Our will, We could have transformed them in their

places. Then they would have been unable to go forward (move about) nor they could have turned back.} On the Day of Resurrection, it will be said to the disbelievers among the sons of Adam, after Hell has been shown to them as a rebuke; and warning: 4This is Hell which you were promised!} meaning, *this is what the Messengers warned you about, and you did not believe them.' 4Bum (enter) therein this Day, for that you used to disbelieve}. This is like the Ayah: r<f 4The Day when they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. Tins is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see?) (52:13-15) TheMouths ofthe Disbelievers willbe sealedon theDay ofResurrection 4 'jf-4*-^! 1*2 (443 -v4> pr.A) 4This Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to earn.} This will be the state of the disbelievers and hypocrites on the Day of Resurrection, when they deny the sins they committed in this world and swear that they did not do that. Allah will

seal their mouths and cause their limbs to speak about what they did. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "We were with the Prophet jg and he smiled so broadly that his molar could be seen, then he jg said: «Do you know why I am smiling?» We said, 'Allah and His Messenger know best.' He said: i. Ju ijjLi Vp-Uajl >J : JjAJ 4jj JuaJI i slilip ^jlJI : JijZj ijLaLi VI V :J_j£» jla::< ^ala'll : jJlS'jS/ Jli'j I aJ lJU |U>4* < Jj-t nj-^uf ' IjJu :JyCi t jiJ «Because of the way a servant will argue with his Lord on the Day of Resurrection. He will say, "O Lord, will You not protect me from injustice?" [AllSh] will say, "Of course." He will say, "I will not accept any witness against me except from myself." [Allah] will say, "Today you will be a sufficient witness against yourself, and the honorable scribes will serve as witnesses against you." Then his mouth will be sealed, and it will be said to his faculties, "Speak!" So they will speak of what he did. Then he will be permitted to speak, and he will say, "May you be doomed! It was for you that I was fighting."*" This was recorded by Muslim and An-Nasal. Ibn Jarir narrated that Abu Mdsa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The believer will be called to account on the Day of Resurrection, and his Lord will show him his deeds, just between him and His Lord. He will admit it and will say, *¥68, O Lord, I did do that.' Then Allah will forgive him his sins and conceal them, and no creature on earth will see any of those sins, but his good deeds will be seen, and he will want all the people to see them. Then the disbeliever and the hypocrite will be brought to account, and his Lord will show him his deeds and he will deny them, saying, 'O Lord, by I1 ' Muslim 4 :2280, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:508.

Your glory, this angel has written down things that I did not do.' The angel will say to him, *Did you not do such and such on such a day and in such a place?' He will say, 'No, by Your glory, I did not do that.' When he says this, Allah will seal his mouth." Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I think that the first part of his body to speak will be his right thigh." Then he recited: iThis Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to eam}J 1] \$And if it had been Our will. We would surely have wiped out their eyes, so that they would struggle for the path, how then would they see?} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, explained it: "Allah says, If We willed, We could have misguided them all away from true guidance, so how could they be guided?" And on one occasion he said, "We could have blinded them."121 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "If Allah willed, He could have covered their eyes and made them blind, stumbling about." Mujahid, Abu Salih, Qatadah and As-Suddi said, "So that they would struggle for the path, i.e., the right way." Ibn Zayd said, "The meaning of path

here is the truth - *How could they see when We have covered their eyes?' ” Al- ‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said: ihorw then would they see?} “Theywould not see the truth. ff} \$And if it had been Our will, We could have transformed them in their places.} [I > At-Tabari 20:544. [2] At-Tabari 20:545. At-Tabari 20:547.

t "i S.'C. 1 * -rll < V 'V(**" %£=*} 3l -tn O' |*^=vyf iAnd among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age, so that he blows nothing after having blown) (22:5). The meaning here - and Allah knows best - is that Allah is telling us that this world is transient and will come to an end, it is not eternal and lasting. Allah says: \$) iWill they not then understand?) meaning, will they not think about how they were created, then they become gray-haired, then they become old and senile, so that they may know that they were created for another world that is not transient and will not pass away, and from which there is no way out, which is the Hereafter. Allah does not teach His Messenger^ Poetry 4\$ Cj Jiili iAnd We have not taught him poetry, nor is it suitable for him.) Allah tells us that He has not taught His Prophet Muhammad poetry. £j) inor is it suitable for him.) means, he did not know how to compose it, he did not like it and he had no natural inclination towards it. It was narrated that he jg never memorized a stanza of poetry with the correct meter or rhyme - he would transpose words or memorize it incompletely. In Ad-Dald'il, Al-Bayhaqi recorded that the Messenger of Allah said to Al-‘Abbas bin Mirdas As-Sulami, may Allah be pleased with him: «Yom are the one who said: "Do you distribute my booty and the booty of the servants between Al-Aqra' and 'Uyainah He said, "It is TJyainah and Al-Aqra'.” He jg said:

sit is all the same .» i.e., it means the same thing. 1 ' 1 And Allah knows best. This is because Allah taught him the Qur'an, which oi Jm/" Si Vj YA oj ^ ^Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it; sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.) (41:42). This is not poetry, as some of the ignorant disbelievers of the Quraysh claimed; neither is it sorcery, a fabrication or a magic spell, as the misguided and ignorant people variously suggested. The Prophet & was naturally disinclined to compose verse, and was forbidden to do so by Divine Law. 4SJ iThis is only a Reminder and a plain Qur'an .) means, it is clear and self-explanatory to the one who ponders and comprehends its meanings, Allah says: dT d iThat he or it may give warning to him who is living,) meaning, so that this plain Qur'an might warn every living person on the face of the earth. This is like the Ayat. 4that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach] (6:19). YY& •->[>>V' cfj) ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place) (11:17). Those who will benefit from his warning will be those whose hearts are alive and who have enlightened insight, as Qatadah said, “Alive of heart and alive of insight.”121 Ad-Dahhak said, 111 Dala'il An-Nubuwwah 5:181, this was also recorded by Muslim no. 121 At-Tabari 20:550.

\$ tiSSS tl« “This means wise.”111 [££jj1 iuj&ji& jjiii ^ o£j^ (fiat Word may be i>i^!j\$ justified against the ' > ,*' '<&*> , >.s disbelievers.) -b*;V"--'^Vp means, it is a mercy to the believers and _ „ -T' \ evidence against the Lji o ^ & disbelievers. juLLj^A^IIU. tiSii- bi s r# ' *C>i *C>\ 1 i'.1i«"i virri 471. Do they not see y ^ J 54^^ f,wf We have created fir c \\\ diem ofwhat Our Hands spp e fa ion f' the cat- tl^bUallj&y tie, so that they are their 471. Do they not see fpdy^sdlU^TJjJk&...il. c iif^.; them ofwhat Our Hands fBPp e fits tion f- the cat- tl^bUajij&y f/e, so that they are their t.— = = - I owners .) 472. And We have subdued them unto them so that some of them they havefor riding and some they eat.)

473. And they have (other) benefits from them, and (they get to) drink. Will they not that be grateful?) There is a Sign and a Blessing in Cattle Allah mentions the blessing that He has bestowed upon His creation by subjugating these cattle for their use. 4^& 4so that they are their owners.) Qatadah said, "They are their masters." Meaning, He has made them subdue them. So they At-Tabari 20 :550

are submissive towards them and do not resist them; even if a young child comes to a camel he can make it kneel down, and if he wants to, he can make it stand up and can drive it, and it will meekly be led by him. Even if the train consists of a hundred or more camels, they could all be led by a young child. 4some of them they havefor riding and some they eat.} means, some of them they ride on their journeys, and use them to carry their burdens to all regions. 4and some they eat.} means, if they want to, and they slaughter and sacrifice them. }And they have (other) benefitsfrom them,} means, from their wool, fur, and hair, furnishings and articles of convenience, comfort for a time. iand (they get to) drink.} means, their milk, and their urine for thosewho need it as medicine, and so on. io &} iWill they not then be grateful?} means, "will they not worship the Creator and Subduer of that, without showing gratitude to others?' A* > u; up ili }74. And they have taken besides Allah, gods, hoping that they might be helped.} 475. They cannot help them, blit they will be brought forward as a troop (against those who worshipped them).} 476. So, let not their speech then grieve you. Verily, We know what they conceal and what they reveal.}

The gods ofthe Idolators are not able to helpThem Allah denounces the idolators for taking the idols as gods alongside Allah, hoping that those gods will help them and provide for them and bring them closer to Allah. Allah says: iThey cannot help them,) meaning, those gods cannot help their worshippers; they are too weak, too insignificant and too powerless. Rather they cannot even help themselves or take revenge on those who want to harm them, because they are inanimate and can neither hear nor comprehend. Allah's saying: i^CiUU £,) ibut they will be broughtforward as a troop.) means, at the time of Reckoning according to the view of Mujahid. 111 This means that those idols will be gathered together and will be presentwhen their worshippers are brought to account, as this will add to their grief and will be more effective in establishing proofagainst them. Qatadah said: iThey cannot help them,) means the gods. ibut they will be broughtforward as a troop.) "The idolators used to get angry for the sake of their gods in this world, but they could not do them any benefit or protect them from any harm, for they were merely idols." This was also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri. This is a good opinion, and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. Consolation for the Mercy to the Worlds i'U\$ UyZ "&) 4So, let not their speech then grieve you.) means, their denying |l) At-Tabari 20 : 552

you and their disbelief in Allah.' 4\$M Cj U p,&} \$Verily, We know what they conceal and what they reveal.} means, We know everything about them, and We will punish them for their false claims and deal with them accordingly on the Day when none of their deeds, great or small, major or minor, will be overlooked, and every deed they did throughout their worldly lives will be laid open for examination.' 5U* U vl _>* bji Aik: j* AjSiL. iSl jJ 2\$} jfL> fkj JLa JjS laLlil uSjii ji (A) [» !»«" ufd ji Jli fSL- aJ TjjJ (>• Jju- LfjS' 477. Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent.} 478. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation . He says : "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?"} 479. Say: "He

will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knower of every creation!" } 480. He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, when behold you kindle therewith. } The Denial of Life after Death, and the Refutation of this Idea Mujahid, Ikrimah, Tharwa bin Az-Zubayr, As-Suddi and Qatadah said, "Ubayy bin Khalaf, may Allah curse him, came to the Messenger of Allah with a dry bone in his hand, which he was crumbling and scattering in the air, saying, 'O Muhammad! Are you claiming that Allah will resurrect this?' He said: tJVC Sit «Yes, Allah, may He be exalted, will cause you to die, then He will resurrect you and will gather you into the Fire." Then these Ayat at the end of Surah Yd Sin were revealed: 4^1iu (>J LSI

223 Surah 36. Yd Sin (77 - 80) (Part-23 4Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah.} - until

the end of the Surah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Al-'As bin Wa'il took a bone from the bed of a valley and crumbled it in his hand, then he said to the Messenger of Allah jg: Will Allah bring this back to life after it has disintegrated?' The Messenger of Allah sg said: "Yes, Allah will cause you to die, then He will bring you back to life, then He will make you enter Hell. Then the Ayat at the end of Surah Yd Sin were revealed." This was recorded by Ibn Jarir from Said bin Jubayr.'2' Whether these Ayat were revealed about Ubayy bin Khalaf or Al-'As bin Wa'il, or both of them, they apply to all those who deny the resurrection after death. The definite article "Al" in 4Does not man (Al-Insan) see...} is generic, applying to all those who deny the Resurrection. liU oi 4that We have created him from Nut/ah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent.} means, the one who is denying the resurrection, cannot see that the One Who initiated creation can re-create it. For Allah initiated the creation of man from semen of despised fluid, creating him from something insignificant, weak and despised, as Allah says: - > <: 'v 4Did We not create you from a despised water? Then We placed it in a place of safety, for a known period?} (77:20-22) ilk^ 4Verily, We have created man from Nutfah } (76:2). [1 * At-Tabari 20:554. This is a Mursal narration, however, the next narration provides authentic support for the Hadith. At-Tabari 20:554.

of the earth, where they have gone when they disintegrated and dispersed. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ribl said: "Uqbah bin 'Amr said to Hudhayfah, may Allah be pleased with him, 'Will you not tell us what you heard from the Messenger of Allah sg?' He said, I heard him jfc say: C-a Cl til :<Lbl jA ill* lO'UJl j] J[O-iUj 2js\ IS] Jj~ ,ji p \^S tia^ J J lii <iil 'JUAj 1 jJLiij ijUJl Jt "•J <iil t >• ijA : jli oLj j»J : J Jli j*j ialJ[«Death approached a man and when there was no longer any hope for him, he said to his family, "When I die, gather a lot of firewood, then set it ablaze until my flesh is consumed and it reaches my bones and they become brittle. Then take them and grind them, and scatter them in the sea." So they did that, but Allah gathered him together and said to him : "Why did you do that?" He said, "Because / feared You." So Allah forgave him.*' 'Uqbah bin 'Amr said, 'I heard him say that, and the man was a gravedigger.' "f ' Many versions of this Hadith were recorded in the Two Sahihs. One of these versions mentions that he commanded his sons to bury him and then grind his remains into small pieces, and then scatter half of them on land and half of them on the sea on a windy day. So they did that, then Allah commanded the sea to gather together whatever remains were in it, and He commanded the land to do likewise, then he said to him, "Be!", and he was a man, standing. Allah said to him. "What made you do what you did?" He said, "The fear of You, and You know best." Straight away He

forgave him.12 ' . . >. ; >•. S TiU# ^i-Vt 4He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, when behold you kindle therewith. 111 Ahmad 5:395. {2] Fath Al-Bari 6 :594, Muslim 4 :2 1 10

means, the One Who initiated the creation of this tree from water, when it has become green and beautiful, bearing fruit, then He changes it until it becomes dry wood with which fires are lit. For He does whatever He wills and He is able to do whatever He wills, and none can stop Him. Qatadah said concerning the Ayah: 54&M AM&p Ar *4 4He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, xvhen behold you kindle therewith. this means, the One Who brought forth this fire from this tree is able to resurrect him. It was said that this refers to the Markh tree and the 'Afar tree, which grow in the Hijaz. If one wants to light a fire but has no kindling with him, then he takes two green branches from these trees and rubs one against the other, and fire is produced from them. So they are just like kindling. This was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him. sM jtij o' & A l&K A Jyk o' z'y .J -i.u 4 AA cop Is not He Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. 482. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!" - and it is!\$ 483. So glorified be He and exalted (above all that they associate with Him), and in Wlwe Hand is the dominion of all things, and to Him you shall be returned Allah points out His great might and power in that He created the seven heavens with all their stars and planets, and the seven earths with everything in them of mountains, sands, oceans and wildernesses, and everything in between. He tells us to find the proof that He will re-create our bodies in His creation of these mighty things. This is like the Ayah: 4o^M A- 0? ofjVfj

227Surah 36. Yd Sin (81 - 83) (Part-23) iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind} (40:57). And Allah says here: its not He IA7jo created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them?} meaning, the like of mankind. So, He will re-create them as He created them in the first place. Ibn Jarir said, "This Ayah is like the Ayah iDo they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not ivearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is able to do all things.} (46:33)" And Allah says here: g \$& *1 4 T£i ,#l £5i jli' 4Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, Hjs command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!"- and it is!} meaning, He only needs to command a thing once; it does not need to be repeated or confirmed. When Allah wants a thing to happen, He only says to it: "Be!" once, and it is. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: 'jif\ lolili- ja V) '•SrAr* ^ 4^ «*•' J)' aJ Luli w lil l «Allah, may He be exalted, says: "O My servants, all of you are sinners apartfrom those whom I protect from sin . Seek My forgiveness and I will forgive you. All ofyou are in need except for those whom I make independent. I am Most Generous, Majestic, and I do whatever I will. My giving is a word and My punishment is a word. When I unmt a thing to happen 1

t-si:s pstuqv hi uiojj psaq siq pasrej aq uaqyyv sqv,qvx uaAas ui syvuns 3uoj uaAas aq; pa;paj aq pus ;q3iu auo q?nv J° JaSuassajM aip q;iM jaXBJd ui poop 'pres 'unq iptAV pasoajd aq qBjy Xbui 'ubuiba-iv uiq qBjXBqpnff ;sq; papjooaj pBUiqv ureuq •sjaqjo puBms/v£ jo sjBioqos aq;jo £»uofeui aqi jo uoiuido aq; si siq; pxre 'paxioa si qoiqM auo aq; si mbia jauuoj aq; ;ng mpai [Brquids oqi qjtM op o; ssq m^tqvjv-jy puB uqsaj [BoisXqd aq; ipiM op o; SBq rypWJV l@qi urrep ajdoad auios qSnoqjiB '3uiqj aures aq; ireaui jrofujapi-jy pire 3{lnH-IV (VL9) i(HlnW-JV) umututop dip si puvp

asoi^vi w» 3ff aq p3ss3jg> it-X jp 7 (88=83) i,,iSuiip/uaaa fo (inyvivw) fquSpuaaos dip si puvjq asopM
wj,, : five;} if f T' Xf? v*> jvfio aq; oqn si is8unp pv fo (pjyvivw) fyuStdjaaos dip si puvpj asoijM ui
puv '(miff iptm. dfvpossv /hip jmp pv aooqo) papvxa puv apj aq paifuofi 05^ ittlfiJp 7 s*' 'qpfiy stqj jo
Sunreaui aqj, •pasodsiQ iCpnoioBJo aq; 'ja/iAo;sag snojaauQ aq; 'srtq aq; si 3H pu® 'spaap siq o;
Suipjooob auo qoBa qsiund jo pjBAiaj qiAv 3H uaqi uoipajjnsay jo j(bq aq; uo lutqaj yon puppreui jp
ui?H 0} pire 'puBUiuiOD pire apajo o; jaMod aq; si sig 'Ujn;aj sjajpui jp uioqyw o; 'qjJBa aq; puB
suaABaq aq; jo pjjuoa aq^ si ptreq asoqyw ui 'uapyjng-jlag aq; 'SuiAiq J3Ag aq; aq fiAa Xub aAoqB
payrpires pus pa;pxa puB payuofS 'susau i'pauutpau aq //m/s noR uitjj oj puv 'sSuiip pv fo uoiunuop
dtp si puvjq asoqM ui puv '(miff ipicn ajvpossv /hip imp pv aojoqv) papvxa puv 3fj aq patfuofi o\$>
tirr / P' [,19,/si ft puv paq, p 0} Rvs fipuaui mpuy uqi Msfvp SZZ

229Surah 36 . Yd Sin (81 - 83) (Part-23 bowing, he said, > * - • ' \ >• | <* , *0JL^>" <U \ £**_*->' lAllah hears the one who praises Him.* Then he said; j O <b Juo-J 'Praise be to Allah, the Owner of Malakiit, might, pride and greatness .» His bowing was as long as his standing position, and his prostration was as long as his bowing. Then he finished and my legs were nearly broken.” Abu Dawud recorded that ‘Awf bin Malik Al-Ashja’i, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I stood in prayer with the Messenger of Allah jg one night and he recited Al-Baqarah. He did not reach any Ayah that mentioned mercy but he paused and asked for it, and he did not reach any Ayah that mentioned punishment but he paused and sought refuge from it. Then he bowed for as long as he had stood, and while bowing he said, tljjjf.Jlj Oj&LJlJ CjffS;Jl jlA— <‘Glory be to Allah, the Owner of might, Malakut, pride and greatnessJ Then he prostrated for as long as he had bowed, and said something similar while prostrating. Then he stood and recited Al ‘Imran, then he recited one Surah after another.”*2 ' This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi in Ash-Shama’il and An-Nasal.’3 '

Surah 37: As-Saffat

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Virtues of Surat As-Saffat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4817–4860]

tin » A SjjJ Jfji \} \C>J "yjJOloy'- il»-fifl UjJ*llia£12[{}!)^Ojfxfl\fi>\j jj/-S4j CP0C}}
iPfCipi3^fjJ>%j^\\jSi,j\\ij ojv^pjiC^ O>>Oi?|P An-Nasa'I recorded that . 'Abdullah bin 'Umar, may
Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah 5= used to command us to make our prayers
short and he used to recite As- Saffat when he lead us in prayer." ' 1 This was recorded by An- Nasa*i
only. Op ^— In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ,,,.' >liu^ t\lxLdl\}T * T .\$2
Q. .A Jli , i csfji& Cjj ,f - -*"r^ fPi vtyj L^l*. Uj JfP\) 'f6pJ 41. By those ranged in ranks.} 42. By those
who drive the clouds in a good way.} ** An-Nasfil 2 :95

i3. By those who bring the Dhikr.4 44. Verily, your God is indeed One;4 45. Lord of the heavens and of
the earth, and all that is between them, and Lord of every point of the sun's risings. The angels witness
to the Oneness of Allah. It was reported that 'Abdullah bin MasUd, may Allah be pleased with him,
said: 4 l j Clii ^ 4By those ranged in ranks . - they are the angels; 4By those who drive the clouds in a
good ioay.4 they are the angels; 4By those ivho bring the Dhikr.4 they are the angels."111 This was also
the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Masruq, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid,
As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ar-Rab!' bin Anas . Qatadah said, "The angels form ranks in the heavens."131
Muslim recorded that Hudhayfah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah^ said:
ji &yua ^ .01 tl "iUJl ISJ J 0 fxfj I4I5 «PVe have been favored over the rest of mankind in three ways:
our ranks have been made like the ranks of the angels; the entire earth has been made a Masjid for us;
and its soil has been made a means of purification for us if we cannot find waterj"141 Muslim, Abu
Dawud, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah recorded that Jabir bin Samurah, may Allah be pleased with him, said,
"The Messenger of Allah sg said: At-Jabari 21 :7. Al-Qurtubi 15:61 62. At-Tabari 21 :7. Muslim 1:371.

233Surah 37. As-Saffat (1-5) (Part-23) s LIS jyuaJ Will you not form ranks as the angels form ranks in
the presence of their Lord? We said, "How do the angels form ranks in the presence of their Lord?' He
jg said: J 'oyZoVjZ i xtuJ 1 <i)jaSj'q "They complete the rows nearer the front and they consolidate the
rows, n"* 1 ' As-Suddi and others said that the Ayah 4 .5"(eO frBy those who drive the clouds in a good
way.fr means that they drive the clouds. i'srjf* ±&%fr frBy those who bring the Dhikr.fr As-Suddi said,
"The angels bring the Scriptures and the Qur'an from Allah to mankind." The One True God is Allah a
M frVerily, your God is indeed One, Lord of the heavens and the earth,fr This is the One by Whom the
oath is sworn, stating that there is no God worthy of worship but He, Lord of the heavens and the earth,
frt&.^fr fraud all that is between them,fr means, of created beings. fraud Lord of every point of the sun's
risings.fr 111 Muslim 1:223, Abu Dawud 1:431, An-Nasal 2:92, Ibn Majah

means, He is the Sovereign Who is controlling His creation by subjugating it and all that is in it of stars, planets and heavenly bodies which appear from the east and set in the west. Mentioning the east is sufficient and there is no need for the west to be mentioned too, because it is implied in what is said. This has also been stated clearly elsewhere, in the Ayat. $yjiSj\ j,0\pounds\ Eii\ 4$ So I swear by the Lord of all the points of sunrise and sunset in the east and the west that surely We are able.} (70:40) $4\ vjj\ \backslash>j\}$ 4(He is) the Lord of the two easts and the Lord of the two wests.} (55:17) which refers to the rising and setting points of the sun and the moon in both winter and summer. $yM\ d!\ —\ V\ if\ ot\ Gill\ Aiiii\ <jh>-y^*\ ijUc\ |^Ij$ if $iy>jkip\ *\ *,r\ sfe\ 46$. Verily, We have adorned the near heaven with the stars . 47. And to guard against every rebellious Shaytan.} 48. They cannot listen to the higher group for they are pelted from every side .} 49. Outcast, and theirs is a constant torment.} 410. Except such as snatch away something by stealing, and they are pursued by aflamingfire ofpiercing brightness.} The Adornment and Protection of the Heaven comes from Allah Allah tells us that He has adorned the lowest heaven with the heavenly bodies for those among the people of the earth who look at it. The stars and planets in the sky give light to the people of earth, as Allah says: $4'\{5^'\ 32if\ \pounds>\ Zsj\}$ 4And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps, and We have made such lamps (as) missiles to drive aivay the

235Surah 37. As-Saffat (6 - 10) (Part-23) Shaydtin, and have prepared for them the torment of the blazing Fire.} (67 :5), $*\ ^\ 4\ .\ L'J\ ^\ j\ ^\ 5\ U1m\pounds$. $j5Jj^\wedge\ ^\ .^\wedge\ ,05—2\ <4A^*\wedge\ Vi$ indeed, We have put the big stars in the heaven and We beautified it for the beholders. And We have guarded it from every outcast Shaytan. Except him z who steals the hearing then he is pursued by a clearflaming fire.} (15 :16-18). And Allah says here: $i\&rj'\}$ }And to guard} meaning, to protect as it should be protected, $i/jfi\ J\&\ .\ j:\}$ iagainst every rebellious Shaytan.} means, every insolent and impudent devil, when he wants to eavesdrop (on news in the heavens), a piercing fire comes and bums him. Allah, may He be glorified, says: $i\$H\ fi\ j)\ SJdZ\ v>\}$ They cannot listen to the higher group} meaning, they cannot reach the higher group - which refers to the heavens and the angels in them - when they speak ofwhat has been revealed by Allah of His Laws and decrees. We have already mentioned this when explaining the Hadiths quoted when we discussed the Ayah, $\{3(\ Jij\ \backslash)i\ p:\bullet Z)$ iwhen fear is banishedfrom their hearts, they say "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say: "The truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} (34 :23). Allah says: $y>XU)f\ ifor\ they\ are\ pelted\}$ meaning, they are hit, ifrom every side.} means, from all directions from which they

try to reach the heaven. $^\wedge$ Outcast,} means, they are rejected, and are repelled and prevented from reaching it, and they are pelted. iand theirs is a constant torment.} means, in the Hereafter, they will have an ongoing, everlasting and painful torment, as Allah says: iand [We] have prepared for tiem the torment of the blazing Fire (67:5). $ims\ at\ \pounds\ i$ Except such as snatch away something by stealing, means, except for the one among the Shayatin who manages to get something, which is a word he has heard from the heaven. Then he throws it down to the one who is beneath him, who in turn throws it down to the one who is beneath him. Perhaps the flaming fire will strike him before he is able to throw it down, or perhaps he will throw it - by the decree of Allah - before the flaming fire strikes him and burns him. So the other devil takes it to the soothsayer, as we have seen previously in the Hadith. Allah says: $it\&Z\#vte\ Si\&f\ viU\ .\ \pounds\ i$ Except such as snatch away something by stealing, and they are pursued by aflaming fire ofpiercing brightness.} meaning, shining brightly. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Shayatin had places where they sat in the heavens listening to what was

being revealed by Allah. The stars did not move and the Shayatin were not struck. When they heard the revelation, they would come down to earth and to every word they would add nine of their own. When the Messenger of Allah was sent, if a Shaytan wanted to take his seat in the heavens, the flaming fire would come and would not miss him; it would burn him every time. They

complained about this to Iblls, may Allah curse him, and he said, 'Something must have happened.' He sent his troops out and they found the Messenger of Allah jg standing in prayer between the two mountains of Nakhlah." - Wald' said, "This means in the valley of Nakhlah." - "They went back to Iblls and told him about that, and he said, This is what has happened.' ",1) _/*t— Ul* oj y IjJj . 1*^1) jvjw J lv 1 jl N . Ij.l 111, U ,J >V , irt-i 1 * * >i,/ * «• <-ri\ ; / f bp ,Jfi) Vw i/ Uu ..'J, 413 . Then ask them : "Are they harder to create, or those whom We have created?" Verily, We created them of a sticky clay.} 432. Nay, you wondered while they mock.} 433. And when they are reminded, they pay no attention.} 414. And ivhen they see an Ayah (a sign) from Allah, they mock at it.} 435. And they say: "This is nothing but evident magic!"} 436. "When we are dead and have become dust and bones, shall we verily be resurrected?"} 417. "And also our fathers of old?"} 418. Say : "Yes, and you shall then be humiliated."} 419. It will be a single Zajrah, and behold, they will be staring!} The Certainty of Life after Death Allah says: 'Ask these people, those who deny the resurrection, which is harder to create? Are they more difficult to create or the heavens, the earth, the angels, devils, the mighty creatures - everything in between them?' Ibn Mas'ud said that they admitted that these things were harder to create than they were. 13 ' If this is the case, then why do they deny the 111 At-Jabari 21 :12. I2 * See the Tafslrof Surat As-Saffat [37 : 19] 131 At-Tabari 21 :19.

239Surah 37. As-Saffat (11 - 19) (Part-23) VI ui 4And they say : "This is nothing but evident magic!"} means, 'this that you have brought is nothing but plain magic.' I . 'U&J LSj Ljji ^j»® ^ . oJJS'i li}Cl* jl .. v' ^W/ien we Are dead and have become dust and bones, shall we (then) verily be resurrected? And also our fathers of old?} They thought that this was unlikely to happen, and they did not believe it. i^ pip S3 p ', ^b i- ^jitr^jU ill j i *i?Lc![V £«\$ jffrtjj' V^ 4Say: "Yes, and you shall then be humiliated" .} means, 'tell them, O Muhammad: Yes, you will be raised up on the Day of Resurrection, after you have become dust and bones, and you will be humiliated,' i.e., put to shame before His great might. This is like the Ayat 4And all shall come to Him, humbled} (27:87), and 4-cZs^* o* ui^£2—i <14^ iVerily, those who scorn My worship, they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!} (40:60) Then Allah says:

f bw oft l2S^> 4^ u«7/ fee a single Zajrah, and behold, they will be staring!) means, it will be a single command from Allah, He will call them once to come forth from the earth, then they will be standing before Him, staring at the horrors of the Day of Resurrection. And Allah knows best. lisa ' it K- prl 4*5# ^ &»> o; \$lf CJ fyllt > j? j3 C^£1 <20. They will say: "Woe to us! This is the Day of Recompense!") ill . (It will be said:) "This is the Day of Judgement which you used to deny.") ^22. (It will be said to the angels:) Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions and what they used to worship,) 123. Instead of Allah, and lead them on to the way of flaming Fire (Hell);) 124. But stop them, verily, they are to be questioned.) 425. "What is the matter with you? Why do you not help one another?") 426. Nay, but that Day they shall surrender.) The Day of Recompense Allah tells us what the disbeliever will say on the Day of Resurrection, how they will blame themselves and admit that they wronged themselves in this world. When they see the horrors of the Day of Resurrection with their own

eyes, they will be filled with regret at the time when regret will not avail them anything. fit&Q& \$\$) iThey will say: "Woe to us! This is the Day of Recompense!") And the angels and the believers will say: -4 s >3' pj> !i*^

241 Surah 37. As-Saffat (20 - 26) (Part-23) iThis is the Day of Judgement which you used to deny This will be said to them as a rebuke and reproof. Allah will command the angels to separate the disbeliever from the believers in the place where they are standing. Allah says: 4(11 will be said to the angels :) Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions} An-Nu'man bin Bashir, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Their companions means their counterparts, those who are like them." ' This was also the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, IkTimah, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Abu Salih, Abu Al-'Aliyah and Zayd bin Aslam."*2 ' Shank said, narrating from Simak, from An-Nu'man: "I heard Umar say: 4Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions means, Those who are like them. So those who committed Zina will be gathered with others who committed Zina, those who dealt in Riba will be gathered with others who dealt in Riba, those who drank wine will be gathered with others who drank wine.' Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr narrated from Ibn 'Abbas: 4their companions} means "Their friends." igJ* \y^ &j} 4and what they used to worship. Instead of Allah,} means, instead of Allah, i.e., their idols and false gods will be gathered together with them in the same place. 4and lead them on to the way of flaming Fire.} means, take them to the way to Hell. This is like the Ayah: 111 At-Tabari 21 :27. ' At-Tabari 21 :27, 28.

242 Tafsir Ibn Kathir >><*. ('.K. >•" /> . >> -i-- C~»- Ulf=> ^+»- 1—>L> l>o> r+\$frj if fj We s/jfl// gather than together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell; whatever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire} (17:97). prl iBut stop than, verily, they are to be questioned.} means, stop them so that they may be questioned about the things they did and said in this world. As Ad-Dahhak said, narrating from Ibn 'Abbas, this means, 'detain them, for they are to be brought to account.' 'Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak said, "I heard 'Uthman bin Za'idah say, The first thing about which a man will be asked is the company that he kept. Then by way of rebuke, it will be said to them: it *& t} iWhat is the matter with you? Wlty do you not help one another?}.' " meaning, 'as you claimed that you would all help one another.' 'j>& 4Nay, but that Day they shall surrender.} means, they will be subjected to the command of Allah, and they will not be able to resist it or avoid it. And Allah knows best. J Js !>Ni if j&l 'jlS f G) Jj> Ue J; U C& Cy jli) JuiT ^ yUi'i 4 jSy & Vi 2\ V fa. Jj lit TJIT 4%ii0' %& f\ 2J 427 . And they will turn to one another and question one another.} 428. They will say : "It was you who used to come to us from

243 Surah 37. As-Saffat (27 - 37) (Part-23) the right side."} 429. They will reply: "Nay, you yourselves were not believers."} 430. "And we had no authority over you. Nay! But you were a transgressing people."} "So now the Word of our Lord has been justified against us, that we shall certainly taste (the torment)." } 432. "So we led you astray because we were ourselves astray."} 433. Then verily, that Day, they will (all) share in the torment.} 434. Certainly, that is how We deal with the criminals.} 435. Truly, when it was said to them: "La ilaha illallah," they puffed themselves up with pride.} 436. And (they) said: "Are we going to abandon our gods for the sake of a mad poet?"} 437. Nay! he has come with the truth and he confirms the Messengers.} The arguing of the Idolators on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us that the disbeliever will blame one another in the arena of Resurrection, just as they will argue with

one another in the levels of Hell: lie i\ c. vpUjtft jjz} Z & t+j dS 3ii dA iThe weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Verily, we followed you, can you then take from us some portion of the Fire?" Those who were arrogant will say: "We are all (together) in this (Fire)! Verily, Allah has judged between (His) servants!"} (40:47-48) ii) iz&x ju js&^ np sii

d ^ o' y jW^L) ' oyl' ti JdfcVi Li«r» X#> ••» Ojj.rf J* :.&» ft G {£\$ '611 4^!o>Cu [yf C ^Bid if you could see when the wrongdoers will be made to stand before their Lord, how they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Tlwse who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!" And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were criminals." Tlwse who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, when they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} (34:31-33) Similarly, they are described here as saying: ^ ft ilt was you ivho used to come to us from the right side.} Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn 'Abbas said; "They will say, 'You used to force us because of your position of power over us, for we were weak and you were strong.'" Qatadah said, "Men will say to the Jinn, 'You used to come to us from the right side to block every good deed, and you told us not to do it and you tried to put obstacles in our way.'" As-Suddi said, "You used to come to us to block the truth, and you made falsehood look attractive to us, and you prevented us from seeing the truth."111 Ibn Zayd said, it means: "You stood in the way between us and goodness, and you repelled us from Islam and faith and doing the good deeds that we had been commanded to do."*2 Yazid Ar-Rishk said, "from La ilaha illaUah." At-Tabari 2 1 :32 At-Tabari 21 :32.

245 Surah 37. As-Saffit (27 - 37) (Part-23) iThey will reply: "Nay you yourselves were not believers."} The leaders of the Jinn and mankind will say to their followers, "It is not as you say; your hearts denied faith and were open to disbelief and sin." U dfc Cj} iAnd xve had no authority over you .} means, "we had no proof of the truth of that to which we called you." iNay! But you were a transgressing people.} *You yourselves were evildoers and transgressors against the truth, so you responded to us and neglected the truth which the Prophets brought with proof, and you went against them.' iSo now the Word of our Lord has been justified against us, that we shall certainly (have to) taste (the torment). So we led you astray because we were ourselves astray.} Those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak, "the Word of Allah has been justified against us, that we are among the doomed who will taste the punishment of the Day of Resurrection." \$So we led you astray} means, 'so we called you to misguidance,' 4fj£.& 4because we were ourselves astray.} means, "we called you to follow the path which we were on, and you responded." Allah says: }Then verily, that Day, they will (all) share in the torment.} means, all of them will be in Hell, each according to what he deserves. Hw&Z ii' 2[V fi Jj lit §} 4Certainly , that is how We deal with criminals. Truly, when it

was said to them: "La ildha illallah," they puffed themselves up with pride. means, in this world they were too arrogant to say these words as the believers said them. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah sg| said: Aii A\ VI JJI V :JU -fii I Jill VI JJ| V : I \)&JU >01 JjtifM&Jt •j>-J J&I 14i>y Vj «JU >» %/ have been commanded to fight

the people until they say La ildha ill-Allah. Whoever says La ildha illallah, he and his property are safe from me except for his obligation, and his reckoning will be with Allah, may He be glorified .n* 1 Allah revealed in His Book the story of people who were arrogant, as He says: >0 \$3 ill\$\$ & V ! Jd't V M iSi #r iTruly, when it was said to them: "La ildha illallah," they puffed themselves up with pride. And (they) said: "Are we going to abandon our godsfor the sake ofa mad poet?"\$ meaning, 'Shall we stop worshipping our gods and the gods of our forefathers just because of the words of this mad poet?' - meaning the Messenger of Allah jg. Allah said in refutation of their attitude: iNay! he has come with the truths meaning, the Messenger of Allah gj has brought the truth with all that Allah has revealed to him of stories and commandments. H60 iand he confirms the Messengers. means, he fulfills their prophecies of his praiseworthy characteristics and his perfect way, and he tells people of the Laws and commands ofAllah, as they said he would. Ii| Muslim 1 :52

247Surah 37. As-Saffit (38 - 49) (Part-23) 4'k5 c* Si ^ C vi Jjj jii »s> iNothing is said to you except what was said to the Messengers before you} (41:43). VJ t* V) Ojyit \Zj ^JVI iyuiji ^->14 \$ rj'^1' y-t»r 4 (**-> ^5* *Ay <4-!^ Vj JJc V . ijj ,-1: , ijj (*?t *-^4 '^ / , JU >y. /> ' ,;rv ^ •/ * *<-X 4 f. * .*'•>' o^ . Or® ^>05® y£ 433. Verily, you are going to taste the painful torment;} 439. And you uu// be requited nothing except for what you used to do. 440. Save the chosen servants ofAllah.} 441 . For them there will be a known provision,} 442. Fruits; and they shall be honored,} 443. In the Gardens ofDelight,} 444. Facing one another on thrones.} 445. Round them will be passed a cup ofpure wine} 446. White, delicious to the drinkers.} 447. Neither will they have GIuiwl from that nor will they suffer intoxication therefrom.} 448. And beside them will be Qasirat-At-Tarf with (wide and beautiful) eyes.} 449. as if they were Boyd Makniin.} The Punishment ofthe Idolators and the Reward ofthe sincere Believers Allah says, addressing the people: fff C VI Uj Sg^VI yliJi jyuTjJ &\} 4Verily, you are going to taste the painful torment; and you will be requited nothing exceptfor what you used to do.} Then He makes an exception in the case of His sincerely believing servants. This is like the Ayat.

4By the Time. Verily, man is in loss, Except those who believe and do righteous deeds...} (103:1-3), ! £*• *^1 ^3 iii iVerily, We created man in the best stature. Then We reduced him to the lowest of the low. Save those who believe arid do righteous deeds} (95:4-6). yS iif ? ^<*2 iThere is not one of you but will pass over it (Hell); this is with your Lord, a decree which must be accomplished. Then We shall save those who have Taqwa. And We shall leave the wrongdoers therein to their knees.} (19:71-72); and &% iEvery person is a pledge for what he has earned, except those on the right} (74:38-39). Allah says here: iSave the clwsen servants of Allah.} meaning, they will not taste the painful torment nor will they be brought to account. Their evil acts, if there are any, will be overlooked, and each good deed will be rewarded in multiples of between ten and seven hundred, or as much as Allah wills. iFor them there will be a known provision,} Qatadah and As- Suddi said, "This means Paradise." * It is explained further in the next Ayah: 4Fruits^ meaning, of different kinds. i&P& m At-Tabari 2 1 :35

iand they shall be honored,} means, they will be served and will live a life ofluxury. jtr-& & iln the Cardens of Delight, facing one another on thrones.} Mujahid said, "One of them will not look at one another's backs."111 0* (** y ^ o? iSllj iRound them will be passed a cup of pure wine - white, delicious to the drinkers. Neither will they have Ghawl from that nor will they suffer intoxication therefrom .} This is like the Ayah % y it cfa tjjh y\$V d'jjj (*4 ilmmortal boys will go around them

(serving), with cups, and jugs, and a glass of flowing wine, from which they will get neither any aching of the head nor any intoxication.}156:17- 19). Allah refined the wine of Paradise from the bad effects of the wine of this world, which causes headaches and stomach aches - which is the meaning of Ghawl - causing people to lose their minds completely. So He says here: iRound them will be passed a cup of pure wine meaning, wine from a flowing stream which they do not fear will ever be cut off or cease. Malik narrated that Zayd bin Aslam said, "White flowing wine," meaning, with a bright, shining color, unlike the wine of this earth with its ugly, repulsive colors of red, black, yellow and turbid shades, and other features which are repugnant to anyone of a sound nature. [i] ioyj^lli iJi} Al-Qurtubi 15:77.

idelicious to the drinkers. means, its taste will be as good as its color, and a good taste indicates that it has a good smell, unlike the wine of this world. 4& IJk 4Neither will they have Ghcrwlfrom that} means, it will not have any effects on them such as causing stomach aches. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd. ' This is unlike the wine of this world, which causes colic and so on, because it is too watery. inor will they suffer intoxication therefrom .) Mujahid said, "It will not cause them to lose their minds."121 This was also the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Al-Hasan. 'Ata' bin Abi Muslim Al-Khurasani, As-Suddi and others. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said, "Wine causes four things: intoxication, headache, vomiting and urine."*3 ' So, when Allah mentions the wine of Paradise, He states that it is free of these characteristics, as mentioned in Surat As-Saffat. 4And beside them will be Qdsirat At-Tarfo means, chaste females, who will not look at anyone other than their husbands, as Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Zayd bin Aslam, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said.*4' iivith (wide and beautiful) eyes ^means, with beautiful eyes. It was also said that it means with wide eyes, which is connected to the first meaning. They are wide-eyed and beautiful, and their eyes are described as being beautiful and chaste. Allah says: 111 At-Tabari 21 :38. 121 At-Tabari 21 AO. I3 ' Al-Qurtubi 15:79. 141 At-Tabari 21 :41, 42.

y issmt& ita qmaw® ns CT ^ ^ ^ v {Aruf beside them will ..*rt 5 .^1 "F r L. /-\\= • fix a . ^ r *,f-s* s * ^ '* .Ay >x <v ***' *' be Qasiraf At-Tarf, with flnrf beauti^l) 4|§JS_#2 j£ <flg yf they were Bay(l '_*A>U»fr->rtni^Kl0j£l(Maknun Their bodies - - j *7^-"^ „•*TU are described as L\$U» having the most ^6i<^oja'(Cuo^acuo^f^^ perfect color - <Ali bin ^^T;T Abi Talhah reported ^o»CJJ that Ibn 'Abbas, may \\ -t* *r ^ ""' " * a i _i i .-it. Sm: Allah be pleased with jVf-31±^13j^ ^*g*S>i3 J£ ^ OyAi^iA^lc<jb>»jLr^==/iijl3 (>_;/^ ^flS t j they were Bayd means . as if ""4- - "" ^ they were hidden pearls.111 Al-Hasan said: 4#S^ j£!S> ias if they were Bayd Maknun. means, protected, never touched by any hands. As-Suddi said, "The well preserved egg in its nest." Said bin Jubayr said: 4f;S^ J£f&> ias if they were Bayd Makniin.} means, "The inside of the egg." 'Ata' A1 Khurasani said, "It is the membrane which is between its outer shell and its inner contents." As-Suddi said: i%Z&&S#> ias if they were Bayd Maknun.}' means, "The white of the egg At-Tabari 2 1 :43

253Surah 37. As-Saffat (50 - 61) (Part-23) all kinds of good food, drink, clothes and other delights no eye has seen, no ear has heard, never having comprehend the mind of man. 4 • *' > 4\$ 4! 144 Jjji 4A speaker of them will say: "Verily, I had a companion..."} Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said, "This refers to an idolator man who had a companion among the believers in this world." iWho used to say : "Are you among those who believe..."} means, 'do you believe in the resurrection after death, and the Reckoning and reward or punishment?' He used to say that by way of

astonishment, disbelief and stubbornness. ftp lll Ij,j ifThat) when we die and become dust and bones, shall we indeed be indebted (Madiniin).} Mujahid and As-Suddi said, “Brought to account.”*2 Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi said, “Rewarded or punished according to our deeds.”*3 * Both views are correct. \$ ji i(The speaker) said: “Will you look down?”} meaning, look over. The believer will say this to his companions among the people of Paradise. 4*§? b* 4 *’*? £pb} iSo he looked down and saw him in the midst of the Fire.} Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Sa*id bin Jubayr, Khulayd Al-TJsari, Qatadah, As-Suddi and ‘Ata’ Al-Khurasani said, “This means, in the middle of Hell.”*’*** Al-Hasan Al- At-Tabari 21 :45. * At-Tabari 21 :47. * At-Tabari 21 :47. * At-Tabari 21:48.

254 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Basri said, “In the middle of Hell as if he were a burning star.” Oj£" j] <iL 4He said: “By Allah! You have nearly ruined me.”4 The believer will say, addressing the disbeliever: ‘By Allah, you nearly caused me to be doomed, if I had obeyed you.’ j,f ili Vjij} 4Had it not been for the grace of my Lord, I would certainly have been among those brought forth (to Hell).} means, Were it not for the favor of my Lord towards me, I would have been like you in the middle of Hell where you are, brought forth with you for punishment. But He bestowed His grace upon me, had mercy upon me and guided me to faith and to belief in Him Alone.’ 4and never could we have found guidance, were it not that Allah had guided us!} (7:43) { Uj 'Vi 7 4Are we then not to die (any more)? Except our first death, and we shall not be punished?} This is what the believers will say when they feel joy at what Allah has given them, and they realize that they are to remain in Paradise forever with no punishment and no death to come. Allah says: jjiii jll Ui } iTruly, this is the supreme success!} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “They know that death brings an end to every delight, so they will say, 4 ""VCfliX*** tjj jjVf biy 4Are we then not to die? Except our first death, and we shall not be punished?} m At-Tabari 21 :48.

255 Surah 37. As-Saffat (50 - 61) (Part-23) It will be said, “No, , jX 'Jkito iTruly, this is the supreme success!^ i" jiiiri) iii iFor the like of this let the lookers work , Ibn Jarir said, “These are the Words of Allah, and it means: for the like of this pleasure and this success, let the workers work in this world, so that they may attain it in the Hereafter. 121 The Story of Two Israelites They mentioned the story of two men among the Children of Israel who were partners and who are included in the meaning of this Ayah. Abu Ja‘far bin Jarir recorded that Furat bin Thalabah Al-Bahrani said concerning the Ayah, Urt} 4\$ 4\$ 4 Verily, I had a companion£ “There were two men who were partners and had collected eight thousand Dinars. One of them had a craft and the other did not. The one who had a craft said to the other, ‘You do not have a craft, so I think I will divide the money with you and leave you ’ So he left him. Then the man bought a house, belonging to a king who had died, for the price of one thousand Dinars. He called his companion and showed him the house, saying, “What do you think of this house? I bought it for one thousand Dinars.’ He said, ‘How beautiful it is.’ When he went out he said, ‘O Allah, this companion of mine has bought this house for one thousand Dinars, I ask You for one of the houses of Paradise - and he gave one thousand Dinars in charity.’ Then as much time passed as Allah willed should pass. The first man married a woman with a dowry of one thousand Dinars, and invited his companion and made food for him. When he came, he said, ‘I have married this woman with a dowry of one thousand Dinars.’ He replied; ‘How beautiful this is.’ And when he left, he said, ‘O Lord, my Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :95 At-Tabari 21:52.

companion has married a woman with a dowry of one thousand Dinars; I ask you for a wife from among Al-Hur Al- 'Iyri - and he gave one thousand Dinars in charity. Then as much time passed as Allah willed should pass. Then the first man bought two gardens for two thousand Dinars, then he called his companion and showed them to him. He said, 'I have bought these two gardens for two thousand Dinars.' He replied, 'How beautiful this is.' When he came out, he said, 'O Lord, my companion has bought two gardens for two thousand Dinars; I ask you for two gardens in Paradise' - and he gave two thousand Dinars in charity. Then the angel came to them and took their souls in death. He took the one who had given his money in charity and put him in a house that he liked. There, there was a woman who was so beautiful that the ground shinned under her, then he (the angel) took him to two gardens and gave him other things which are known only to Allah. The man said, 'This is like a man who has such and such.' The angel said, 'That is exactly what it is; this house, these gardens and this wife are all for you.' The man said, 'I had a companion who used to say: Are you among those who believe?' It was said to him, 'He is in Hell.' He said, 'Will you look down?' So he looked down and saw him in the midst of Hell. At this, he said: 'Vjjj 4By Allah! You have nearly ruined me. Had it not been for the grace of my Lord, I would certainly have been among those brought forth (to Hell f&sA U } oj f 462 . Is that (Paradise) better entertainment or the tree of Zaqqum?^ PI At-Tabari 21 :45. This narration is among those, the Muslim is not required to believe in

257 Surah 37. As-Saffat (62 - 70) (Part-23) 463. Truly, We have made it (as) a trial for the wrongdoers 464. Verily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hell- fire, 465. The shoots of its fruit stalks are like the heads of Shayatin .} 466. Truly, they will eat thereof and fill their bellies therewith .} 467. Then on the top of that they will be given boiling Hamim.} 468. Then thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell.} 469. Verily, they found their fathers on the wrong path;} 470. So they (too) hastened in their footsteps!} The Tree of Zaqqum and its Companions Here Allah asks: Is that which He has mentioned of the delights of Paradise with its food, drink, companions and other joys better entertainment, or 4or the tree of Zaqqum} which is in Hell?' The meaning here is a specific kind of tree which is called Zaqqum. This is like the Ayah: 4 . oj c: 4And a tree that springs forth from Mount Sinai, that grows (produces) oil, and (it is a) relish for the eaters.} (23:20) - which is the olive tree. This is supported by the Ayah: 4Then moreover, verily, - you the erring-ones, the deniers! You, verily, will eat of the trees of Zaqqum.} (56:51-52). 4Truly, We have made it (as) a trial for the wrongdoers.} Qatadah said, "The tree of Zaqqum is mentioned as a test for those who are misguided. They said, 'Your companion tells you that in the Fire there is a tree, but fire consumes trees.' Then

Allah revealed the words: iVerily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hell-fire.} meaning, it is nourished by the fire, for it was created from fire." Mujahid said: iTruly, We have made it (as) a trial for the wrongdoers.} Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, said, "Zaqqum means dates and butter which I eat \Atazaqqamuhu.]"[2i I say that the meaning of the Ayah is, "We have told you, O Muhammad, of the tree of Zaqqum as a trial with which We test the people to see who will believe and who will disbelieve." This is like the Ayah: a j v3j Jk iii, gzl cf} iAnd We made not the vision which we showed you but a trial for mankind, and the accursed tree in the Qur'an. We warn and make them afraid but it only increases them in naught save great disbelief, oppression and disobedience to Allah} (17:60). iVerily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hell-fire.} means, its roots grow at the bottom of Hell. }The shoots of its fruit stalks are like the heads of Shayatin.} this is a description of how ugly and

repulsive it is. It is likened to the heads of Shaydīn), even though they have never seen them, because it is a well-established idea in people's minds that devils are ugly in appearance. . At-Tabari 21:52. At-Tabari 21:53.

Truly, they will eat thereof and fill their bellies therewith. Allah mentions that they will eat of this extremely ugly tree even though its fruit tastes and smells so bad; they will be forced to eat from it because they will not find anything else to eat except this tree and similar things, as Allah says: > t -> No food will there be for them but a poisonous thorny plant, Which will neither nourish nor avail against hunger. (88:6-7). 4 'Xfb ft- i.l iThen on the top of that they will be boiling Hamim Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "This means they will be given boiling Hamim. to drink after they have eaten from Zaqqum."il] According to another report, he said that this means a mixture made from boiling water ' Someone else said that it means boiling water will be mixed with pus and offensive discharges that leak from their private parts and eyes. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Saïd bin Jubayr said, "When the people of Hell get hungry, they will ask for food from the tree of Zaqqum. They will eat from it, then the skin of their faces will fall off, If someone were to pass by, he would recognize them from their faces. Then thirst will be sent upon them, so they will ask to be given something to drink, and they will be given water like boiling oil that has been heated to the ultimate degree. When it is brought near to their mouths, the flesh of their faces from which the skin has fallen off will be baked by its heat, and whatever is in their stomachs will melt. They will walk with their guts falling out and with their skin falling off, then they will be beaten with hooked rods of iron. Then every part of their bodies will burst into loud lamentations. [I] At-Tabari 21:55. At-Tabari 21:52. For an explanation of Hamim, see the Tafsir of SuratAr-Rahman (55 :44)

Then thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell.} means, after that interval, they will be sent back to the burning fire, searing heat and scorching flames, and they will rotate between the one and the other. This is like the Ayah, iThey will go between it (Hell) and the fierce boiling water!} (55 : 44). Qatadah recited this Ayah when discussing this Ayah. This is a good interpretation. 'Abdullah bin Mas'Qd recited it differently, with the meaning "Their return in the afternoon." 'Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, used to say: "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, midday on the Day of Resurrection will not come until the people of Paradise will be in Paradise and the people of Hell will be in Hell." Then he recited: v !" • 4-?y. 5-^J iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose} (25:24). Allah's saying; iVerily, they found their fathers on the wrong path;} means, We will punish them for that because they found their fathers following misguidance and they followed them with no evidence or proof.' Allah says: if^ 4So they (too) hastened in their footsteps!} Mujahid said, "This is like running."*3 * Saïd bin Jubayr said, "They followed ignorance and foolishness." At-Tabari 21:56. At-Tabari 21 :56. At-Tabari 21 :57.

261 Surah 37. As-Sdffit (71 - 82) (Part-23) j&j} jj5j iw.cjjj'si'? jUlt VI , VT' joUl 4_iic- And indeed most of the earlier ones went as- tray before them ;} 472. And indeed We sent among them warners;} 473. Then see what was

the end of those who were warned.} 474. Except the chosen servants of Allah.} Allah tells us that most of the previous nations went astray, worshipping other gods alongside Allah. He states that He sent among them warners to alert them to the anger, wrath and vengeance of Allah towards those who

disbelieve in Him and worship others besides Him. He tells us that they persisted in their opposition to their Messengers and their disbelief in them, so He destroyed those who disbelieved in Him and saved the believers and caused them to prevail. Allah says: *rJj SStSliSS m JU f > > iff > OJJjy OJJ --jV ^ri/. iyJLjutJ\5 4jJ] CA-^J li i\$ti 0SjblSE2&#j\$ (j\liUaVy ^auaTj^14^ 4||p)&J£^lt 4&(Slit V[0^ ullgsa iThen see what was the end of those who were warned. Except the chosen servants ofAllah}. Pi? jSjptJI y'Jsjl" qP blub d* 4 #3* jYY^uuOt /*

262 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr \$75. And indeed Niih invoked Us, and We are the best of those who answer. i76. And We rescued him and his family from the great distress,\$ \$77. And, his progeny, them We made the survivors. \$78. And left for him (a goodly remembrance) among the later generations£- \$79. “Salam (peace!) be upon Niih among the all creatures!”\$ \$80. Verily, thus We reward the gooddoers . \$ \$81. Verily, he [Niih] was one ofOur believing servants. \$82. Then We drowned the others . \$ Nuh and His People When Allah tells us about how most of the early people went astray from the path of salvation, He starts the detailed explanation of that with the story of Niih and the rejection of his people. Only a few of Nuh’s people believed in him, despite the long period of time he spent among them. He stayed among them for one thousand years less fifty, and after he stayed among them for so long and their disbelief became too much for him to bear - for every time he called them, they turned away from him even more - he prayed to his Lord saying, “I have been overcome, so help (me)I” So Allah became angry because Nuh was angry with them. He says: \$And indeed Niih invoked Us, and We are the best of those who answer. \$And We rescued him and hisfamilyfrom the great distress. means, their disbelief and their insults. \$And, his progeny, them We made the survivors. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be

pleased with him, “There was no one left apart from the offspring of Nuh, peace be upon him.”! ' Said bin Abi ‘Arubah said, narrating from Qatadah concerning the Ayah, iAnd, his progeny, them We made the survivors .} “All people descended from the offspring of Nuh, peace be upon him.”121 At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim narrated from Samurah, may Allah be pleased with him, that

the Prophet jg said, concerning the Ayah, iAnd, his progeny, them We made the survivors}: “Sam, Ham and Yafith.^ Imam Ahmad recorded from Samurah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah said: «Sam was the father of the Arabs, Ham was the father of the Ethiopians and Ydfith was the father of the Romans This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi.15 * What is meant here by Romans is the original Romans, i.e., the Greeks who claimed descent from Ruma (Roma) the son of Liti, the son of Ydnan, the son of Yafith, the son of Nuh, peace be upon him. •(*->> iAnd leftfor him among the later generations .} Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “He is remembered in a good way.”*6 * Mujahid said this means “An At-Tabari 21:59. 121 At-Tabari 21 :59. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :365 , At-Tabari 21 :59. See the note below. 141 Ahmad 5 :9 ls Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :98 The majority consider these to be unauthentic 161 At-Tabari 21 :60.

honorable mention by all the Prophets.”111 Qatadah and As- Suddi said, “Allah caused him to be praised constantly by others.”*2 * Ad-Dahhak said it means “Salam and praise.” iSalam (peace!) be upon Nuh among the all creatures!} This explains for us the extent of the honorable mention and praise, for he is greeted with peace by all groups and nations. iVerily, thus We reward the gooddoers.} means, This is how We reward those of Our servants who do deeds of obedience to Allah. We gave him an

honorable mention so that after he died he is still remembered in a manner that befits his status.' Then Allah says: 4Verily, he [Nuh] was one of Our believing servants. meaning, one of the sincere believers in the Oneness of Allah, one of those who had certain faith. iThen We drowned the others .} means, We destroyed them, and there was no trace whatsoever left of them, and they are only known by this unfavorable description.' Ijl* .Ajjb JIS ii. Jlf .ylw If 'fU^ <>f i})* A4IJI KCLl ijs 463. And verily, among those who followed his way was Ibrahim.} 464. When he came to his Lord with a Salim heart.} 465. When he said to his father and to his people: "What is it that zvhich you worship?"} 466. "Is it a falsehood - gods other than Allah - that you desire?"} At-Tabari 21 :60. At-Tabari 21 :60.

265 Surah 37. As-Sdffat (83 - 87) (Part-23 487. "Then what think you about the Lord of the all that exists?"} The Story of Ibrahim and His People 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him: 4And verily, among those wlv followed his ways was Ibrahim.} means, he was one of the followers of his religion. * Mujahid said, "He was following his path and his way."*21 ^ Ho •>*^ 4When he came to his Lord with a Salim heart.} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "This means that he bore witness that none has the right to be worshipped except Allah."*3 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Awf said, "I said to Muhammad bin Sirin, 'What is the Salim heart?' He said, 'One which knows that Allah is true and that the Hour will undoubtedly come to pass, and that Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.'"*4 * Al-Hasan said, "One that is free from Shirk . ""*5' *Urwah said, "One that is not cursed."*6 .44jJ aJj, <JU 4When he said to his father and to his people: "What is it that which you worship?"} He denounced his people for their worship of idols and false gods, Allah said: (1 * At-Tabari 21:61. * At-Tabari 21 :61. * Al-Qurjubi 15:91 * Al-Qurtubi 15:91 *s * At-Tabari 21 :62. > At-Tabari 21 :62.

III At-Tabari 2 1 :63

-cx. iSo they turned away from him and departed. Qatadah said, "The Arabs say of one who thinks deeply that he is looking at the stars."11 ' What Qatadah meant is that he looked at the heavens thinking of a way to distract his people. So he said, ififr 4i> iVerily, I am sick.} meaning, weak. Ibn Jarir narrated here a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, stating that the Messenger of Allah jg said: 4)1 olbrdhim (peace and blessings be upon him) did not lie except in three cases. Two were for the sake of Allah: (one is) wheti he said, 4Verily , I am sick}; and (the second) when he said, iNay, this one, the biggest (his wife) of them (idols) did it.} and (the third) when he said concerning (his wife) Sarah, "She is my sister. "> This Hadith is recorded in the books of the SahOi and Sunan with various chain of narrations.12' But this is not the kind of real lie for which a person is to be condemned - Allah forbid! One calls it a lie for lack of a better word, because it is abstruse speech used for a legitimate religious purpose, and it was said that what was meant by the words, 4Verily , I am sick} was, 1 am sick at heart of your worshipping idols instead of Allah.' Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "The people of Ibrahim went out to their festival and they wanted to make him go out too. So he lay down on his back and said, ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7:100. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 6:447, Muslim 4:1840, Abu Dawud 2:659, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi9:5, An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :440

268 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4>> iVerily, I am sick.} and he started looking at the sky. When they had gone out, he turned to their gods and broke them." 11 This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Allah said: iSo they turned away from him and departed.} meaning, he went to them after they had left, quickly and

secretly. vi iand said: "Will you not eat?"} They had placed food before them as a sacrifice, so that the food might be blessed. When Ibrahim, peace be upon him, looked at the food that was before them, he said: iWill you not eat? What is the matter with you that you speak not?} iThen he turned upon them, striking (them) with (his) right hand.} Al-Farra' said, "This means, he started to hit them with his right hand." Qatadah and Al-Jawhari said, "He turned to them, hitting them with his right hand."12 * He struck them with his right hand because the right hand is stronger and more powerful. Then he left them broken to pieces, (all) except the biggest of them, that they might turn to it, as we have already seen in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya')3 ^ iThen they came hastily towards him.} Mujahid and others said, "This means, they came rushing. The story is told in brief here; in Surat Al-Anbiya', it is told in more detail. When they returned, they did not know at first who had done this, until At-Tabari 2 1 :63 [2 At-Tabari 21 :67. * See volume six, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya' [21 :58j

269Surah 37. As-Saffit (88 - 98) (Part-23) they investigated and found out that Ibrahim, peace be upon him, was the one who had done it. When they came to rebuke him, he started rebuking and criticizing them and said: 4Worship you that which you carve?) meaning, 'do you worship instead of Allah idols which you yourselves carve and fashion with your own hands?' £f> ^s) iWhile Allah has created you and what you make!) This may mean, 'Allah has created you and what you do,' or it may mean, 'Allah has created you and what you make.' Both views are synonymous. The former is more apparent because of the report recorded by Al-Bukhari in the Book Afal Al-'Ibad from Hudhayfah, attributed to the Prophet L*J 41)1 «j|D «Allah has created every doer of deeds and what he does. Thereupon he recited: is; &j) iWhile Allah has created you and what you make! When the proof had been established against them, they resolved to seize him by force and they said: j tjijl iBuild for him a building (i.e., furnace) and throw him into the blazing fire!) There happened what we have already discussed in our Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya', (21:68-70) and Allah saved him from the fire and caused him to prevail over them, making his proof supreme and supporting it. Allah says: jUiVt GT J}&) iSo, they plotted a plot against him, but We made than the lowest.) *** As-Sunnah, Ibn Abi 'Asim 1 :158.

aJ fj-p {vr\$QSfr'^&tCLIIUS , ^ *V c ii)|lO ^ **A£&2Jl3J;0sl^^pjij lj jagi^\$^ojiifc^e ^ ' ji^otjl*_i_jy^3;difJfjJ ejvil'jLl 4 ,j-^A-r* -aJJ (JLUj I. <~jL>J oJJ 4: ii'i 4i \$5^ i*t 4 v* 'jy •'? it^rr" ^ilL ii^lij 'V^otaJ^lf 4v li£ 4 a 4:1 4i s& 34 ^3 lit; >5 «ag3 4 LVXwb 3\$ ^ c*tji £S ^j^c^QL&t Sj 5tf iS oil Jo*, ov-t>oJ fi\$jj uli.1 j/4> # .rf, l»V^ ciiv> -LJ 'AJ cf^ Juif #C5^ !&'< 2 lis <fil jt'r& eh *%% # ^ ^ 4 4a ^ iBiiT ^>**81 iks & \$ & iSjSjS^ **J 3*J irP ^Lrt) :]*;05»4^* oj 499. And he said: "Verily, I am going to my Lord. He will guide me!" 4100. "My Lord! Grant me (offspring)from the righteous."} 4101. So, We gave him the glad tidings of aforbearing boy .} 4102. And, when he (his son) was old enough to walk with him, he said: "O my son! I have seen in a dream that I am slaughtering you. So look ivhat you think!" He said: "O my father! Do that which you are commanded, if Allah wills, you shallfind me of the patient."} 4103. Then, when they had both submitted themselves, and he had laid him prostrate on hisforehead;} 4104. We called out to him: "O Ibrahim!"}

271Surah 37. As-Sdffdt (99 - 113) (Part-23) 4105. "You have fulfilled the dream!" Verily, thus do We reward the doers ofgood.4 4106. Verily, that indeed was a manifest trials 4107. And We ransomed him with a great sacrifice;} 4108. And We leftfor him among the later generations.> 4109. "Saldm (peace!) be upon Ibrahim!"} 4110. Thus indeed do We reward the doers ofgood.} 4111. Verily, he was one ofOur

believing servants.} 4112. And We gave him the glad tidings of Ishaq - a Prophet from the righteous.} 4113. We blessed him and Ishaq. And of their progeny are (some) that do right, and some that plainly wrong themselves.} Ibrahim's Emigration, the Test of the Sacrifice of Isma'11, and how Allah blessed Him Allah tells us that after He helped His close friend Ibrahim, peace be upon him, against his people, and after Ibrahim gave up hoping that they would ever believe despite all the mighty signs that they had witnessed, he emigrated away from them, and said: $\text{uj} < 4 \text{ v}^* \text{'ii } 4\text{J v-i}^* 41^{\wedge} 4$ Verily, I am going to my Lord. He will guide me! My Lord! Grant me (offspring) from the righteous.} meaning, obedient children, in compensation for his people and relatives whom he had left. Allah said: 4 So We gave him the glad tidings of a forbearing boy.} This child was Ismail, peace be upon him, for he was the first child of whom glad tidings were given to Ibrahim, peace be upon him, and he was older than Ishaq. The Muslims and the People of the Book agree, and indeed it is stated in their Book, that Ismail, peace be upon him, was born when Ibrahim, peace be upon him, was eighty-six years old, and Ishaq was born when Ibrahim was ninety-nine years old. According to their Book, Allah commanded Ibrahim to sacrifice his only

son, and in another text it says his firstborn son. But here they falsely inserted the name of Ishaq. This is not right because it goes against what their own Scripture says. They inserted the name of Ishaq because he is their ancestor, while Ismail is the ancestor of the Arabs. They were jealous of them, so they added this idea and changed the meaning of the phrase "only son" to mean the only son who is with you,' because Ismail had been taken with his mother to Makkah. But this is a case of falsification and distortion, because the words "only son" cannot be said except in the case of one who has no other son. Furthermore, the firstborn son has a special status that is not shared by subsequent children, so the command to sacrifice him is a more exquisite test. i And, when he (his son) was old enough to walk with him,} means, when he grew up and started to go with his father and walk with him, for Ibrahim used to go every so often to check on his son and his mother in the land of Faran (i.e., Makkah), to see how they were doing. It was said that he used to ride on Al-Burdq, traveling there swiftly, and Allah knows best. It was reported from Ibn 'Abbas, peace be upon him, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Zayd bin Aslam and others that $\wedge (\& \text{ iAtid}$, when he (his son) was old enough to walk with him,} means, when he became a young man and was able to work as his father did. i LJ} 4 is) 6[$\wedge \text{ £ ££} > \text{ iAnd}$, when he (his son) was old enough to walk with him, he said: "O my son! I have seen in a dream that I am slaughtering you. So look what you think!" TJ Bayd bin TJ mayr said, "The dreams of the Prophets are revelation," then he recited this Ayah: J&S j.EK 4 is} 41 ££ m At-Tabari 21 :72 73.

273 Surah 37. As-Saffat (99 - 113) (Part-23) he said: "O my son! I have seen in a dream that I am slaughtering you. So look what you think He told his son that in order to make it easier for him, and also to test his patience and resolve, at a young age, in obeying Allah and obeying his father. i£y U jlif fa} } He said: "O my father! Do that which you are commanded.. ." meaning, 'obey the command of Allah and sacrifice me.' iif Allah wills, you shall find me of the patient. meaning, 'I will be patient and will seek the reward for that with Allah.' He, may peace and blessings be upon him, believed in what had been promised. Allah said: jjLrfiHj /till yX iiij 'ifv o&j Jcfi j _)*>[)} & ij&b iAnd mention in the Book Isma'il. Verily, he was true to what he promised, and he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet. And he used to enjoin on his family the Salah and the Zakah, and his Lord was pleased with him.} (19:54-55). iThen, when they had both submitted themselves, and he had laid him prostrate on his forehead;}

means, when both of them had pronounced the Shahadah and remembered Allah - Ibrahim because he was about to offer a sacrifice and Ismail because he was about to die. Or it was said that “submitted themselves” means that they submitted and followed the command of Allah; Ibrahim obeyed the command of Allah and Ismail obeyed Allah and his father. This was the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Ishaq, 121 and others. At-Jabari 21 :75. 121 At-Tabari 21 :77.

The meaning of the phrase “and he had laid him prostrate

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4860–4873]

on his forehead” is: he placed him facedown so that he could slaughter him from behind, and not have to see his face at the time of slaughter, so that it would be easier for him. Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said: and he had laid him prostrate on his forehead; } means, “He turned him upside down on his face.” 1 11 Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When the rituals were enjoined upon Ibrahim, peace be upon him, the Shaytan appeared to him at the Mas’a and raced with him, but Ibrahim got there first. Then Jibril, upon him be peace, took him to Jamrat Al-‘Aqabah and the Shaytan appeared to him, so he stoned him with seven pebbles until he disappeared. Then he appeared him at Al- Jamrah Al-Wustd and he stoned him with seven pebbles. Then he laid him prostrate on his face. Ismail, peace be upon him, was wearing a white shirt, and he said, ‘O my father, I do not have any garment in which I can be shrouded apart from this; take it off me so that you can shroud me in it.’ He started to take it off, then he was called from behind: 3} 40 Ibrahim! You have fulfilled the dream!} Ibrahim turned, and saw a fine, homed, white ram.” Ibn ‘Abbas said, “We used to look for similar types of rams.”*2 ' Hisham mentioned this Hadith at length in Al-Manasik. 4VJe called out to him: “O Ibrahim! You have fulfilled the dream!”} means, The purpose of your dream has been fulfilled by your laying down your son to sacrifice him.’ As-Suddi and others said that he passed the knife over Ismail’s neck, but it did not Al-Tabari 21 :77, 78. •2| Ahmad 1 :297.

cut him at all, because a sheet of copper was placed between them. Ibrahim was called at that point, and it was said: iVerily, thus do We reward the doers of good means, this is how We deal with those who obey Us in things that are difficult for them; We make for them a way out.’ As Allah says: Jt* J6 Jv* <j*J v ji Map tdfk iAnd whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out (from every difficulty). And He will provide him from (sources) he never could imagine. And whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him. Verily, Allah will accomplish his purpose. Indeed Allah has set a measure for all things. (65:2-3). On the basis of this Ayah and this story, some of the scholars of Usui have stated that it is valid for a ruling to be abrogated before anyone is able to act upon it - unlike some of the Mutazilah. The evidence for this is obvious, because Allah commanded Ibrahim, peace be upon him, to sacrifice his son, then He abrogated that and pointed out the ransom. The purpose of His command had been primarily to reward His close Friend for his patience and resolve in sacrificing his son. Allah says: 4©^' iytlfl 'fr 'i* di>\\$ iVerily, that indeed was a manifest trial. meaning, it was clearly a test when he was commanded to sacrifice his son, so, he hastened to do it, in submission to the command of Allah and in obedience to Him. Allah said: 111 At-Tabari 21:74.

276 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4 And of Ibrahim who fulfilled all that. \$ (53:37), and 4 And We ransomed him with a great sacrifice>. It was reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “A ram which had grazed in Paradise for forty years.” Imam Ahmad recorded that Safiyyah bint Shaybah said, “A woman from Bani Sulaym, who was the midwife of most of the people in our household, told me that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ sent for Uthman bin Talhah, may Allah be pleased with him.” On one occasion she said, “I asked ‘Uthman, Why did the Prophet ﷺ call you?’ He said. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to me, ‘I saw the horns of the ram when I entered the House [i.e., the Ka’bah], and I forgot to tell you to cover them up; cover them up, for there should not be anything in the House which could distract the worshipper.’” Sufyan said, “The horns of the ram remained hanging in the House until it was burned, and they were burned too.”² This offers independent evidence that the one who was to be sacrificed was Ismail, peace be upon him. The Quraysh had inherited the horns of the ram that Ibrahim sacrificed, and they had been passed down from generation to generation, until the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was sent. And Allah knows best. Reports which state that the One Who was to be sacrificed was Isma‘³, and that this is Correct without a Doubt Sa’id bin Jubayr, ‘Amir Ash-Sha’bi, Yusuf bin Mihran, Mujahid, ‘Ata’ and others reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that it was At-Tabari 21 :90. ² Ahmad 4 :68

277 Surah 37. As-Saffat (99 - 113) (Part-23) Ismail, peace be upon him. Ibn Jarir narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The one who was ransomed was Ismail, peace be upon him. The Jews claimed that it was Ishaq, but the Jews lied.” It was reported that Ibn Tjmar said, “The sacrifice was Ismail.”¹²¹ Ibn Abi Najih said, narrating from Mujahid, “It was Ismail, peace be upon him.”¹³¹ This was also the view of Yusuf bin Mihran.¹⁴ ‘Ash-Shalai said, “It was Ismail, peace be upon him, and I saw the horns of the ram in the Ka’bah.”^[51] Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Al-Hasan bin Dinar and ‘Amr bin Tjbayd from Al-Hasan Al-Basri that he did not doubt that the one of the two sons Ibrahim was commanded to sacrifice was Ismail, peace be upon him.¹⁶ * Ibn Ishaq said, “I heard Muhammad bin Ka’b Al-Qurazi say. The one whom Allah commanded Ibrahim to sacrifice of his two sons was Ismail.’ We find this in the Book of Allah, because when Allah finishes the story of the one of the two sons of Ibrahim who was to be sacrificed, He then says: i And We gave him the glad tidings of Ishaq - a Prophet from the righteous>, and 4 So, We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq and after Ishaq, of Ya’qub} (11:71). He mentions the son and the son of the son, but He would not have commanded him to sacrifice Ishaq when He had promised that this son would in turn have a son. The one whom He commanded him to sacrifice can only have been Ismail.”¹⁷ ‘ Ibn Ishaq said, “I heard him say that often.”⁸ ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 21:83. ^[2] At-Tabari 21:82. ^[3] At-Tabari 21 :84. ^[4] At-Tabari 21:84. ¹⁵¹ At-Tabari 21 :84. ¹⁶¹ At-Tabari 21:85. [’] At-Tabari 21 :84. [’] At-Tabari 21 :85.

278 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Ibn Ishaq reported from Buraydah bin Sufyan bin Farwah Al- Aslami that Muhammad bin Ka’b Al-Qurazi told them that he mentioned that to Umar bin ‘Abd Al-‘Aziz, may Allah be pleased with him, when he was Khallfah, while he was with him in Syria. Umar said to him, “This is something about which I have never given any thought, but I see that it is as you say.” Then he sent for a man who was with him in Syria, a Jew who had become a Muslim and was committed to Islam, and he thought that he had been one of their scholars. Umar bin ‘Abd Al-‘Aziz, may Allah be pleased with him, asked him about that. Muhammad bin Kah said, “I was with Umar bin ‘Abd Al-‘Aziz. Umar said to him, Which of the two sons of Ibrahim was he commanded to sacrifice?’ He said,

Ismail. By Allah, O Commander of the faithful, the Jews know this, but they were jealous of you Arabs because it was your father about whom Allah issued this command and the virtue that Allah mentioned was because of his patience in obeying the command. So they denied that and claimed that it was Ishaq, because he is their father.’ ”*11 ‘Abdullah bin Al-Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal, may Allah have mercy on him, said, “I asked my father about which son was to be sacrificed - was it Ismail or Ishaq?” He said, “Ismail.” This was mentioned in Kitab Az-Zuhd.}2^ Ibn Abi Hatim said, “I heard my father say, The correct view is that the one who was to be sacrificed was Ismail, peace be upon him.” He said, “And it was narrated that ‘Ali, Ibn Umar, Abu Hurayrah, Abu At-Tufayl, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Mujahid, Ash-Shahi, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Abu Jafar Muhammad bin ‘Ali and Abu Salih, may Allah be pleased with them all, said that the one who was to be sacrificed was Ismail.”131 Al-Baghawi said in his Tafsir, “This was the view of ‘Abdullah bin Umar, Said bin Al-Musayyib, As-Suddi, Al-Hasan Al- Basri, Mujahid, Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and Al-Kalbi.”*4 ' This was also reported from Ibn At-Tabari 21 :85. Az-Zuhd, ‘Abdullah bin Ahmad; 80. AMabari 21 :82-84. *41 Al-Baghawi 4:32

279 Surah 37. As-Saffat (114 - 122) (Part-23) ‘Abbas and from Abu ‘Amr bin Al-‘Ala’. 4And We gave him the glad tidings of Ishaq - a Prophet from the righteous. having given the glad tidings of the one who was to be sacrificed, who was Ismail, Allah immediately follows that with mention of the glad tidings of his brother Ishaq. This is also mentioned in Surah Hud (11:71) and in Surat Al-Hijr (15:53-55). 4a Prophet means, from him there will come a righteous Prophet. 4We blessed him and Ishaq. And of their progeny are (some) that do right, and some that plainly wrong themselves.} This is like the Ayak. } cMJ W *4\$; & ^ 4It was said: "O Nuh! Come down (from the ship) with peace from Us and blessings on you and on the people wlv are with you, but people to whom We shall grant their pleasures (for a time), but in the end a painful torment will reach them from Us."} (11:48) v. oj £+*£> try & l> K&Zij J^2£2Jf f&ss ybf£ Ql y^yy ^ '» l4/j it ^ri 4114. And, indeed We gave Our grace to Musa and Hariin .} 4115. And We saved them and their people from the great distress,} 4116. And helped them, so that they became the victors;} 4117. And We gave them the clear Scripture;}

280 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4118. And guided them to the right path . 4129. And We left for them among the later generations 4220. "Salam (peace!) be upon Musa and Harun!"} 4222. Verily, thus do We reward the doers of good.} 4122. Verily, they were two of Our believing servants.} Musa and Harun Allah tells us how He blessed Musa and Harun with prophethood and how He saved them, along with those who believed, from the oppression of Fir'aun and his people, who had persecuted them by killing their sons and sparing then- women, and by forcing them to do the most menial tasks, then ultimately He caused them to prevail over them and to seize their lands and their wealth and all that they had spent their entire lives amassing. Then Allah revealed to Musa the Clear and Mighty Book, which is the Tawrah, as Allah says: 4^fj& irj> £fC 4And indeed We granted to Musa and Harun the criterion (of right and wrong), and a shining light} (21:48). And Allah says here: 4And We gave them the clear Scripture; and guided them to the right path.} meaning, with regard to words and deeds. Syffi 4 j -tr- \$%}} 4And We left for them among the later generations.} means, that after they died they would be mentioned in good terms and spoken of highly. Then Allah explain this further: 4Salam (peace!) be upon Musa and Harun! Verily, thus do We reward the doers of good. Verily, they were two of Our believing servants.}

vty 'Sfy Alii" lEU >yj& <u>f SC 'i j l3^y jj 2J0 eg? 30 Cl "1. #5*3*«-9! '^'1 I 4 ^ Sf i Jli ^ ^ Ip^ojVf (*t^ U*Al*)Cj <u>f SC* vi^ J tje^r**** j l3^y HBScsySliill -vt>Si-^i Jj j£ (4-S .MJj^Sl ft \$\$\$»£& eg? ^ftl Cl ^ ^ CJ^CZ^'otoZ i ©jLi^jJpX^i3^ im - And verily> IhJds ~T~ > lyzrv^.^ri . WflS one 0/ the |p <ZjUy>*yfyJ'j3ljJjifliiyij^y^ai Messengers AiriUQf; A f U4 - men he said to /i/s peop/e; Wf// y0(< ^ not have Tatpva?"} Up0n ga i ancj forsake fwr|5c^J flpSJjS^l^uf the Best of creators, ' - il26. Allah, your Lord and the Lord ofyourforefathers?"} il27. But they denied him, so they will certainly be brought forth,} 4128. Save the cfwsen servants ofAllah.} 4129. And We leftfor him among the later generations.} 4130. "Salam (peace!) be upon IlyasTn!"} 4131. Verily, thus do We reward the doers ofgood.} 4132. Verily, he was one ofOur believing servants.} Ilyas Qatadah and Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "Ilyas is another name for Idris."111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin 111 At-Tabari 21 : 95.

Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Ilyas is Idris."* 11 This was also the view of Ad-Dahhak . * Wahb bin Munabbih said, "He is Ilyas bin Yasln bin Finhas bin Al-Tzar bin Harun bin 'Imran ."131 Allah sent him to the Children of Israel after Hizqil (Ezekiel), may peace be upon them both. They had started to worship an idol called Bal, and he called them to Allah, may He be exalted, and forbade them to worship anyone besides Him. Their king believed in him, then he apostatized, and they persisted in their misguided ways, and not one person among them believed in him. So he prayed to Allah against them, and Allah withheld the rain from them for three years. Then they asked him to relieve them from that, and promised that they would believe in him if rain came to them. So he prayed to Allah for them, and the rains came, but they persisted in their evil ways of disbelief. So he asked Allah to take him to Him. Al-Yasa' bin Akhtub had grown up under his care, may peace be upon them both. So Ilyas was commanded to go to such and such a place, and whatever mount came to him, he was to ride on it and not to give it away. A horse of fire was brought to him, so he rode it, and Allah clothed him with light and covered him with feathers, and he used to fly with the angels as a human angel, heavenly yet also earthly. This is what was narrated by Wahb bin Munabbih from the People ofthe Book; Allah knows best how true it is. iWlien he said to his people: "Will you not have Taqwa?" means, 'do you not fear Allah when you worship others instead of Him?' iWill you call upon Ba'l andforsake the Best of creators,) Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, *Ikrimah, Qatadah and As-Suddi said that the word Ba'l means lord . 'Ikrimah and Qatadah said, "This is the language of the people 111 Al-Qurtubi 15:115. At-Tabari21:97. 131 At-Jabari 21:97. At-Tabari 21:96.

of Yemen."11 * According to another report from Qatadah, it is the language ofAzd Shanu'ah.12' 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam narrated from his father that it is the name of an idol which was worshipped by the people of a city called Balabak (Baalbek) which is to the west of Damascus.13 * Ad-Dahhak said, "It is an idol which they used to worship."14 Syj§} 4Will you call upon Ba'l} means, 'will you worship an idol,' iand forsake the Best of creators, Allah, your Lord and the Lord ofyourforefathers?} means, "He is the One Who is deserving ofyour worship alone, with no partners or associates.' 4But they denied him, so they will certainly be broughtforth,} means, for the punishment on the Day of Reckoning. if& Sfe iSave the chosen servants of Allah.} means, those who believe in Him alone. 4 <J,& &j} 4And We leftfor him among the later generations.} means, he is praised and spoken of highly. 4Sal8m (peace!) be upon Ilyastn!} Similarly, one might say for Ismail, IsmaIn. This is the language (dialect) of Bani Asad; they say Mikal, MHcaH, and MikaIn. They say Ibrahim and Ibrahim;

Isratl, Israln; Tur Slna', Tur Slnln. All ofthat is fine. At-Tabari 21:96. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7:119. ,3] At-Tabari 21 :97. 141 At-Tabari 21:97.

iVerily, thus do We reward the doers of good. Verily, he was one ofOur believing servants.) We have already discussed the meaning of this above. ' And Allah knows best. C/-J <4 ^1 i <-£ i) o!}) 4233. And verily, Lut was one of the Messengers.) 4234. When We saved him and hisfamily, all,) 4235. Except an old woman (liis wife) who was among those who remained behind.) 4236. Then We destroyed the rest.) 4237. Verily, you pass by them in the morning.) 4236. And at night; will you not then reflect?) The Destruction ofthe People ofLut (Lot) Allah tells us that He sent His servant and Messenger Lut, peace be upon him, to his people, and they denied him, so Allah saved him from among them, him and his family with the exception of his wife, who was destroyed along with her people. Allah destroyed them with different kinds of punishments, and made their vicinity a foul, stinking lake which is on a well-travelled route where people pass by night and day (i.e., the Dead Sea, which lays close to the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah on the highway between Arabia and Syria). Allah says: iVerily, you pass by them in the morning. And at night; will you not then reflect?) meaning, "will you not learn a lesson from them and how Allah destroyed them, and realize that a similar end awaits the disbelievers.' (i] See Surat As-Saffat (37 :80-81)

Ji 0& (**Lj JI jjl **£ 4 jj 5. sir -jSS 'JJS \$gjj£ .& i.jit \$31 t\$S&z£(%<& *: (as& £\$s %&%&&&mps£4 fSyir 4! !>^ (_j5 ijL 4^ 4l'1 "J'J 4139. And verily, Yunus was one of the Messengers.) 4140. When he ran to the laden ship:} 4141. Then he (agreed to) cast lots, and he was among the losers.} 4142. Then a (big) fish swallowed him as he had done an act worthy ofblame.} 4143. Had he not been ofthem who glorify Allah,} 4144. He would have indeed remained inside its belly (the fish) till the Day ofResurrection .} 4145. But We cast him forth on the naked shore while he was sick,} 4146. And We caused a plant ofgourd to grow over him.} 4147. And We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more.} 4148. And they believed; so We gave them enjoyment for a while.} The Story ofYunus We have already discussed the story of Yunus, peace be upon him, in Surat Al-Anbiya' (21:87-88). In the Two Sahths it is reported that the Messenger of Allah said: "(~r* 0< LfT : AjJ </t is not right for any person to say I am better than Yunus bin Matta 4When he ran to the laden ship.} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "It was filled with cargo. 111 Fath Al-Bari4 :193 , Muslim 4 :1846

iThen he (agreed to) cast lots,\$ means, to draw lots." iand he was among the losers .> means among those who have been overcome. This was because the ship was being pounded by the waves on all sides, and they were at risk of drowning, so they drew lots, and whoever lost would be thrown overboard so as to lighten the load. The Prophet of Allah Yunus, peace be upon him, lost the draw three times, but they did not want to throw him overboard. He took off his garment so that he could throw himself into the sea, and they tried to stop him. Then Allah commanded a large fish from the Green Sea (i .e Mediterranean Sea) to cleave the oceans and come and swallow Yunus, peace be upon him, without cutting his flesh or breaking his bones. The fish came and Yunus, peace be upon him, threw himself overboard, and the fish swallowed him and took him away, traveling through all the seas with him. When Yunus had stayed for some time in the fish's belly, he thought that he had died; then he moved his head and legs and arms, and saw that he was alive. He prayed in the belly of the fish, and one of the things he said in his main prayer was: "O Lord, I have taken as a place of worship to You a place which

no other person has reached.” They differed as to how long he spent in the belly of the fish. Some said three days; this was the view of Qatadah. Some said seven days; this was the view of Ja'far As-Sadiq, may Allah be pleased with him. Some said forty days; this was the view of Abu Malik.*2 * Mujahid said, narrating from Ash-Sha'bi, “It swallowed him in the morning and cast him forth in the evening.” And Allah knows best how long exactly was. Allah says, £A 4 64 (§3 U& 4Had he not been of them who glorify Allah, He would have At-Tabari 21 :106. 121 At-Tabari 21:111.

287Surah 37. As-Saffat (139 - 148) (Part-23) indeed remained inside its belly (the fish) till the Day of Resurrection It was said that, if he had not already done righteous deeds during his time of ease. This was the view of Ad-Dahhak bin Qays, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Wahb bin Munabbih, Qatadah and others,111 and it was the view favored by Ibn Jarir.'2 ' This is

what is indicated in the authentic Hadith which we quote

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4873–4889]

below, if Allah wills. In a Hadith narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, he jg said: BoJlJLJl jilt ^11 J (iRemember Allah during times of ease and He will remember you during times of difficultyJ*3 ' And it was said that what was meant by the Ayah: &X ft 4Had he not been of thetn who glorify Allah, was the meaning of the following Ayat. U 4t ^ xi A x J 4 &£> 4But he cried through the darkness (saying): “La ilaha ilia Anta, You are glorified! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers So We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress. And thus We do deliver the believers .)> (21:87-88). This was the view of Said bin Jubayr and others.'4 ' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him - and I do not know of anything narrated from Anas that he did not attribute to the Messenger of Allah jg: yt y&JO 1 *}{,'jl J IjO ^ \j 0 ^3 i I jj 1' cJJu J\ ikUJi cJf XI Ji X j\$Jl :Jl£ o^l jk jJLA s m 6^* s Ijbb uJj L . cJl) At-Tabari 21 :108, 109. 121 A^-Tabari 21:108. [3' Ahmad 1 :307. 141 At-Tabari 21:110*:

288 Tafoir Ibn Kathlr ^ ^J L ! IjJU ^3jjj j yu Lil ! ^JLuj 41)1 tjLci SJLju Jk£a JI* J £>3i jja p ^iJl [j^y. hxS :j} } 1,3-1Ji :J»-j 3 ^3 aUl-^Jl 0 IS” La y Yj i k 1 J L ! I^Jli ^a!-_- * . 1'y.z r* a Iy*i lj 4>*fa3 Oj>Jl yfc a ! Jli 1 a I «Wheii it occurred to the Prophet Yunus, upon him be peace, to call upon Allah in these words when he was in the belly of the great fish, he said, "Id ildhd ilia Anta, Yo are glorified! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers ." This call went and hovered around the (mighty) Throne, and the angels said, "O Lord, this is the voice of one who is weak but known, in a faraway strange land. Allah, may He be exalted, said, "How do you know this?" They said, "O Lord, who is he?" Allah, may He be exalted, said, "My servant Yunus." They said, "Your servant Yunus, from whom there kept coming acceptable deeds and supplications which were answered?!" They said, "O Lord, will You not have mercy on him for what he did during his time of ease, and save him from this trial and tribulation?" He said, "Of course." So, He commanded the great fish, and it cast him forth on the naked shore Allah says: i*£X2i} iBut We cast him forth} meaning, We threw him out,' ion the naked shore} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others said that this refers to land in which there is no vegetation and no buildings. iwhile he was sick,} means, when he was weak of body. I 1 ' At-Tabari 21 :109. This narration contains Yazid Ar-Raqashi. Under the comments on Surah Sad 38:21, Ibn Kathlr grades his narrations unauthentic

289 Surah 37. As-Saffdt (139 - 148) (Part-23 iAnd We caused a plant of gourd to grow over him.) Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with them both, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Sa'Id bin Jubayr, Wahb bin Munabbih, Hilal bin Yasaf, 'Abdullah bin Tawus, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and several others, all said that gourd means squash.' Some of them mentioned that the squash has a number of benefits: it grows quickly, its leaves offer shade because of their large size and smooth texture, flies do not come near it, and its fruits provide good nourishment; they may be eaten raw or cooked, and both the pulp and the peel may be eaten. It was reported that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to like squash and would look for it wherever it was on the serving dish.'² iAnd We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more.} It is as if he was commanded, after he came forth from the fish, to go back to those to whom he had been sent in the first place, and they all believed in him. ior even more.} Makhul said, "They numbered one hundred and ten thousand. This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. Ibn Jarir said, "Some of the scholars of Arabic, the people of Basrah, said that this means up to one hundred thousand or more."³ ' Ibn Jarir interpreted this Ayah as he interpreted the Ayat li J* cL_» *-} iThen, after that, your hearts were hardened and became as stones or even worse in hardness} (2:74). iBehold! a section of them fear men as they fear Allah or even more} (4:77), and 111 At-Tabari 21 :113 and 114, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7:130 131. 2| Al-Bukhari no. 2092. At-Tabari 21:116.

291 Surah 37. As-Saffdt (149 - 160) (Part-23) 4149. Now ask them: "Are there (only) daughters for your Lord and sons for them?"} 4150. Or did We create the angels female while they were witnesses?} 4151 . Verily, it is of their falsehood that they say :} 4152. "Allah has begotten." And, verily, they are liars!} 4153. Has He (that) chosen daughters rather than sons?} 4154. What is the matter with you? How do you decide?} 4155. Will you not then remember?} 4156. Or is there for you a plain authority?} 4157. Then bring your Book if you are truthful!} 4158. And they have invented a kinship between Him and the Jinn, but the Jinn know well that they have indeed to appear (before Him).} 4159. Glorified be Allah! (He is free) from what they attribute unto Him!} 4160. Except the servants of Allah, whom He chooses.} Refutation of Those Who attribute Children to Allah and say that the Angels are His Daughters Allah denounces those idolators who attribute daughters to Allah - exalted be He above that - and attributed to themselves what they desired, i.e., they wanted male offspring to themselves. 4 And when the news of (the birth of) a female (child) is brought to any of them, his face becomes dark, and he is filled with inward grief.} (16:58), i.e., that upsets him, and he would only choose sons for himself. Allah says: Then how can they attribute to Allah the share that they would not choose for themselves? Allah says: 4J-&L&} 4 Now ask them} means, quiz them by way of denunciation, 44£\$ Zb

iHas He (then) chosen daughters rather than sons?) meaning, what would make Him choose daughters rather than sons? This is like the Ayah, iHas then your Lord preferred for you sons, and taken for Himself from among the angels daughters? Verily, you indeed utter an awful saying.) (17:40) Allah says: iWhat is the matter with you? How do you decide?) meaning, "what kind of reasoning makes you say that?" jOlp ji P) iWill you not then remember? Or is there for you a plain authority?) means, 'evidence to prove what you say.' o[PfC \jfc) iThen bring your Book if you are truthful!) means, 'produce evidence for that derived from a Book revealed from heaven by Allah, to prove that He has taken what you say (i.e., offspring). What you say is totally irrational.' iAnd they have invented a kinship between Him and the Jinn,) Mujahid said, "The idolators said that the angels were the daughters of Allah. Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Then who are their mothers?' They said. The daughters of

the leaders of the Jinn.”¹¹¹ Qatadah and Ibn Zayd also said this. Allah - may He be blessed and exalted - says: m At-Tabari 21:121.

295 Surah 37. As-Saffat (161 - 170) (Part-23) Allah!" } 4170. But (now) they disbelieve therein, so they will come to blow! } No One believes what the Idolators say except Those Who are even more misguided than They Allah says, addressing the idolators: 4 So, verily you and those whom you worship cannot lead astray, except those who are predestined to burn in Hell! } meaning, "the only ones who will believe what you say and follow your misguided ways of false worship are those who are more misguided than you and are created for Hell." 'frj bxrix. \$ ^ ^ £y** fit 4 They have hearts wherewith they understand it, and they have eyes wherewith they see not, and they have ears wherewith they hear not (the truth). They are like cattle, nay even more astray; those! They are the heedless ones. } (7:179). This is the parable of the people who follow the belief and ideas of Shirk, disbelief and misguidance, as Allah says: 5* Jji '£[} i Certainly, you have different ideas. Turned aside therefrom is he who is turned aside (by the decree of Allah). } (51:8-9) meaning, the one who is misled by it is the one who is turned aside. The Place of the Angels and Their Ranks glorify Allah Then Allah says, declaring the angels to be above the position attributed to them by those who disbelieved in them and told lies about them - that they are the daughters of Allah - 4 And there is not one of us (angels) but has his known place; } meaning, each one has his own place in the heavens and in

256 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the places of worship, which he does not overstep. Ad-Dahhak said in his Tafsir. "A And there is not one of us (angels) but has his known place; } Masruq used to narrate that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, The Messenger of Allah jg said: jL a-IP Nl ^9^4 u: jji » JD l U» "There is no place in the lower heaven without an angel standing or prostrating in it." This is what Allah says: fU< (d Uf \aj } A And there is not one of us (angels) but has his known place (or position). }.' It was reported that Ibn Mas'ud said, "In the heavens there is one heaven in which there is no space a hand span wide but there is the forehead or the foot of an angel on it." Then he recited: 2 % ti } A And there is not one of us (angels) but has his known place; } 12' Said bin Jubayr similarly said: A And we (angels), we stand in rows. } means, we stand in rows to worship, as we have already seen in the Ayah A By those ranged in ranks (or rows) } Abu Nadrah said, "When the Iqamah had been given, Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, would turn to face the people and say: 'Make your rows straight, for Allah wants you to At-Tabari 21 :127. At-Tabari 21 :127.

297 Surah 37. As-Saffat (161 - 170) (Part-23 follow the ways of the angels.' Then he would say, 4. And verily, we stand in rows; } 'Move back, O so-and-so, move forward, O so-and-so.' Then he would go forward and say 'Allahu Akbar*' This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ In Sahih Muslim it is narrated that Hudhayfah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said, W»ji^a lii ^01 LLai8 &.SJ "We have been favored above mankind in three things: our rows have been made like the rows of the angels; the whole earth has been made a place of prayer for us; and its soil is a means of purification for us. 8 ""21 £3 %> } i And verily, we indeed are those who glorify. } means, "we stand in rows and glorify the Lord, praising Him, sanctifying Him and declaring Him to be above any faults or shortcomings. We are servants of Him and in need of Him, humbling ourselves before Him." The Quraysh wished that They could have a Reminder as had the Men of old \$ a*& & <Si i And indeed they used to say : "If we had a reminder as had the men of old, we would have indeed

been the chosen servants of Allah!"} means, "they used to wish - before you, O Muhammad, came to them - that they would have someone to remind them about Allah and what happened in earlier times, and to bring them the Book of Allah.' This is like the Ayat oi jji, ."L- ly*~Aj} 1 "V /// «:C Dir At-Tabari 21 : 128. 121 Muslim 1 :371

ps t% iAnd they swore by Allah their most binding oath that if a wamer came to them, they would be more guided than any of the nations (before them); yet when a wamer came to them, it increased in them naught but flight (from the truth).} (35:42), and ~)i O6 Lij Oi Xj>\ & iii; ^ 13 \& ji '* — '.if .*<«- i— '.s' if ..fi-" •; jffi "< />-- 4lit C— 0** SXbj 4 .. oy CL <_>UuJ{ *ji 41-tfsf you should say: "The Book was sent down only to two sects before us, and for our part, we were in fact unaware of what they studied." Or lest you should say: "If only the Book had been sent down to us, we would surely have been better guided than they." So now has come unto you a clear proof from your Lord, and a form of guidance and a mercy. Who then does more wrong than one who rejects the Ayat of Allah and turns away therefrom? We shall requite those who turn away from Our Ayat with an evil torment, because of their turning away.} (6:156-157) Allah says here: 'ti y\$& iBut they disbelieve therein, so they will come to know!} This is a definite and stem threat because of their disbelief in their Lord and their rejection of His Messenger Jj- ft j!i j!rl £5^5} IsulT e.i"* 2Sj^ fjp^i if ilgj0jLiLj &p 4 *jj-> jpj ^.yv- £> Jjij 4172 . And, verily. Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers,} i172. That they verily would be made triumphant,} 4173. And that Our hosts! they verily would be the victors.}

299Surah 37. As-Saffat (171 - 179) (Part-23 4174. So, turn awayfrom them for a while,} 4175. And watch them and they shall see!} 4176. Do they seek to hasten on Our torment?} 4177. Then, when it descends in their courtyard, evil will be the morningfor those who had warned!} 4178. So, turn awayfrom them for a while,} 4179. And watch and they shall see!} The Promise ofVictoryand theCommand to turn away from Idolators Allah says, %>Z&\$ ^ 4And, verily, Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers,} meaning, it has already been stated in the first decree that the Messengers and their followers will ultimately prevail in this world and the Hereafter. This is like the Ayah: qda# iit 4Allah has decreed: "Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerfd, Almighty.} (58:21), and f CJ!' }£h ^ i£*. ds&j 4Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will standforth.} (40:51). pi) 4And, verily. Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers, that they verily would be made triumphant,} meaning, "in this world and in the Hereafter, as We have already stated that they would prevail over their people who disbelieved in them and went against them, and how Allah destroyed the disbelievers and saved His believing servants.'

\$Atid that Our hosts they verily would be the victors.} means, that they would ultimately prevail. yjr ^ iSo turn away from them for a while,} means, "bear their annoyance with patience and wait until an appointed time, whenWe shall cause you to prevail and will grant you victory.' 4And watch thetn and they shall see!} means, "watch them and see what will happen to them by way of punishment for then-opposition towards you and their disbelief in you.' Allah said, as a threat and a warning, 4£>\rg*. Sfj} iand they shall see!}. Then Allah says: 4Do they seek to hasten on Our torment?} meaning, "they seek to hasten on the punishment because they disbelieve in you, and Allah is angry with them because of that and will make them suffer the consequences, and because of their disbelief and stubbornness, He

will hasten on the punishment.' cJP **2 pjf&tb 4Then, when it descends in their courtyard, evil will be the morningfor those who had been warned!} means, when the punishment comes down to the place where they are, terrible will be the day of their punishment and destruction. As-Suddi said: iThen, when it descends in their courtyard,} means, in their homes; .XI*} 4evil will be the morningfor tlwse who had been warned!} means, how terrible that morning will be for them. It was

301Surah 37. As-Saffat (180 - 182) (Part-23) reported in the Two Sahihs that Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "On the morning of Khaybar, when the people came out with their tools (to go about their daily work) and saw the (Muslim) army, they went back and said, 'Muhammad by Allah! Muhammad and the army!' The Prophet^ said: tjjiijl iLJ\$ idL* lij !l s*g\ iul» uAUahu Akbarl Khaybar has been destroyed. Then, when it descends in the courtyard of any people, evil will be the morningfor those who had been warned!'^^ }] 4So turn awayfrom them for a while, and watch and they shall see!} This is a reiteration of the command stated above. And Allah knows best. yj A Jc fSdj d id yj 4W',ddd£& 4180. Glorified be your Lord, the Lord ofAl-'Izzah! (He is free) from what they attribute unto Him!} 4181. And Salam (peace!) be on the Messengers!} 4182. And all the praises and thanks be to Allah, Lord of all that exists.} Allah glorified Himself and states that He is far above what the lying wrongdoers say about Him; glorified and sanctified and exalted be He far above what they say. Allah says: yj% -j^L} 4Glorified be your Lord, the Lord ofAl-Tzzah!} meaning, the Owner ofmight and powerWhom none can resist. id} 4(He is free) from what they attribute unto Him!} means, from what these lying fabricators say. \$ pdj} Fath Al-Bari 2 :107 , Muslim 2 :1043

303Surah 37. As-Saffat (180 - 182) (Part-23) Other Hadiths concerning the expiation for any wrongs that may have occurred during a gathering prescribe saying the words: "Glory be to You, O Allah, and praise. There is no God except You; I seek your forgiveness and I repent to you." I have written a chapter dealing exclusively with this topic.

Surah 38: Sad

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4890–4895]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Sad (Chapter - 38) which was revealed in Makkah. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Those who disbelieve are in false pride and opposition. How many a generation have We destroyed before them! And they cried out when there was no longer time for escape. We have already discussed the separate letters in the beginning of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. By the Qur'an full of reminding.} 42. Those who disbelieve are in false pride and opposition. 43. How many a generation have We destroyed before them! And they cried out when there was no longer time for escape.} We have already discussed the separate letters in the beginning of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. if) if'y%} togsfiso 3)ii1 y/*i V' ,, +s . *> ?/?/ Jfk\$)>*02 J £Jc Hr HJPf)>P^jiPb0i^b^oytf^Pig>> \$i%oi0 ki*r LgJUaJI^jAMmW, g^SbJlajUj fc_Aig(3)*9 a. wj, , ./ / ^ "i * / ^ " //aSfc, 4By the Qur'an full of reminding.} means, by the Qur'an which includes all that is in it as a reminder and a benefit to people in this life and the Hereafter. Ad-Dahhak said that the Ayah,

4 <s>) 4full of reminding.) is like the Ayah, 4&* pi '©a> indeed. We have sent down for you (O mankind) a Book in which there is Dhikr (reminders) (21:10). i.e., your reminder. 111 This was also the view of Qatadah and of Ibn Jarir. 121 Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Said bin Jubayr, Ismail bin Abi Khalid, Ibn Tjyaynah, Abu Husayn, Abu Salih and As-Suddi said: ji) ifull of reminding.) "Pull of honor," i.e., of high standing. 131 There is no contradiction between the two views, because it is a noble Book which includes reminders and leaves no excuse and brings warnings. The reason for this oath is to be found in the Ayah: 4Not one of them but denied the Messengers; therefore My torment was justified.) (38:14). Qatadah said, "The reason for it is to be found in the Ayah 'M 4^ Si) 4Nay, those who disbelieve are in false pride and opposition).'^ This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir. 151 4"iS^ti^rj X/- j j£& Jjf f.) 4Nay, those who disbelieve are in false pride and opposition.) means, in this Qur'an there is a reminder for those who will be reminded and a lesson for those who will learn a lesson, At-Tabari 21:140. 121 At-Tabari 21 :140. At-Tabari 21 :139, 140. At-Tabari 21:140. At-Tabari 21 :141

307 Surah 38. Sad (1 - 3) (Part-23) but the disbelievers will not benefit from it because they are in false pride^ meaning, arrogance and tribalism, and opposition .} means, they are stubbornly opposed to it and go against it. Then Allah scares them with news of how the nations who came before them were destroyed because of their opposition to the Messengers and their disbelief in the Scriptures that were revealed from heaven. Allah says: 4How many a generation have We destroyed before them!} meaning, disbelieving nations. \$And they cried out} means, when the punishment came to them, they called for help and cried out to Allah, but that did not save them at all. This is like the Ayat 4Then, when they perceived (saw) Our torment, behold, they (tried to) flee from it. Flee not, but return to that wherein you

lived a luxurious life, and to your homes, in order that you may be questioned.} (21:12-13). Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that At-Tamlmi said, "I asked Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, about the Ayah: *Jw 1,% 1)£>}* 4And they cried out when there was no longer time for escape.} He said that it was not the time for them to call or flee or escape. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, concerning the Ayah: *ctij V&}* 4And they cried out when there was no longer time for escape.}

"They called for Tawhld when their lives were over, and they resorted to repentance when their lives were over." Qatadah said, "When they saw the punishment, they wanted to repent when there was no longer time to call out." Mujahid said: *jj>- sij \jA*}* 4And they cried out when there was no longer time for escape.} "It was not the time to flee or escape." Allah says: *iwhen there was no longer timefor escape.}* meaning, there was no time to escape or run away; and Allah knows best. *'-u.y Wl yA I* ojijfrdi jlij 'frS jLS J c \p Vorm ttza&& 4 f 3i b .•y ,0%*^ Ui si*)* (jj ^ A ^ &> A**. % |AA fi J> off} Oi {Xri' C. xJr 4 \juftr lyl Ej frjij li* And they wonder that a wamer has come to them from among themselves. And the disbelievers say: "This is a sorcerer, a liar."} 45. "Has he made the gods into One God. Verily, this is a curious thing!"} 46. And the leaders among them went about (saying): "Go on, and remain constant to your gods! Verily, this is a thing designed!"} 47. "We have not heard (the like) of this in the religion of these later days. This is nothing but an invention!"} 48. "Has the Reminder been sent down to him (alone) front among us?" Nay, but they are in doubt about My Reminder! m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 : 145

309Surah 38. Sad (4 - 11) (Part-23) Nay, but they have not tasted (My) torment!} 49. Or have they the treasures of the mercy of your Lord, the Almighty, the Real Bestower?} 410. Or is it that the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them is theirs? If so, let them ascend up with means!} 411 . They will be a defeated host like the Confederates of the old times.} The Idolators were amazed at the Message, Tawhidand the Qur'an Allah tells us that the idolators wondered at the sending of the Messenger of Allah sgt as a bringer of glad tidings and a wamer. This is like the Ayah: *& 3 \p: <lm fij ^•S -5" v y* ' IP' ^ - •• ' - I / f.f'h.f h » lit * #/ ^ » /•i* 41s it a wonder for mankind that We have sent Our revelation to a man from among themselves (saying) : "Warn mankind, and give good news to those who believe that they shall have with their Lord the rewards of their good deeds?" (But) the disbelievers say: "This is indeed an evident sorcerer!"} (10:2). And Allah says here: *4'rri ^* 4And they wonder that a wamer has come to them from among themselves.} meaning, a human being like themselves. *m# @4*'Sr^ to m* 4And the disbelievers said: "This is a sorcerer, a liar. Has he made the gods into One God?"} meaning, does he claim that the One Who is to worshipped is One and there is no god besides Him? The idolators - may Allah curse them - denounced that and were amazed at the idea of giving up Shirk, because they had learned from their forefathers to worship idols and their hearts were filled with love for that. When the Messenger W, called them to rid their

hearts of that and to worship Allah Alone, this was too much for them and they were astounded by it. They said: Has he made the gods into One God? Verily, this is a curious thing!" And the leaders among them went about} meaning the chiefs and masters and nobles, *^(saying): "Go on..."}* meaning, 'persist in your religion,' iand remain constant to your gods!}, meaning, 'do not respond to Muhammad's call to Tawhxd.' *aCi&& i*Verily, this is a thing designed!} Ibn Jarir said, "The Tawhld to which Muhammad is

calling you is something by which he wishes to gain power over you, and exalt his own position, so that he will have followers among you, but we will not respond to him.”¹¹¹

The Reason for the Revelation of These Ayat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4895–4916]

Abu Ja'far bin Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When Abu Talib fell sick, some of the people of the Quraysh, including Abu Jahl, entered upon him and said, ‘Your brother’s son is insulting our gods; he does such and such and says such and such. Why don’t you send for him and tell him not to do that?’ So he sent for the Prophet ﷺ and he entered the house. There was space enough for one man to sit between them and Abu Talib, and Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, was afraid that if [the Prophet ﷺ] were to sit beside Abu Talib he would be more lenient with him, so he jumped up and sat in that spot, and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ could find nowhere to sit near his uncle, so he sat by the door. Abu Talib said to him, ‘O son of my brother, why are your people complaining about you and claiming that you are from the gods?’” At-Tabari 21:152

Surah 38. Sad (4-11) (Part-23) insult their gods and say such and such?’ They made so many complaints against him. Thereupon, he said, ‘If, O uncle, all that I want from them is one word which, if they say it, the Arabs will become their followers and the non-Arabs will pay jizyah to them.’ They were worried about what he said, so they said, ‘One word? Yes, by your father, (we will say) ten words! What is it?’ Abu Talib said, “What word is it, O son of my brother?” He said, «Si'i 'i/i iii »L« ilaha illallah. They stood up in agitation, brushing down their clothes, saying, ‘Has he made the gods into One God. Verily, this is a curious thing!’ Then this passage was revealed, from this Ayah to the Ayah: ‘Nay, but they have not tasted (My) torment!’” This is the wording of Abu Kurayb.*¹¹ Something similar was also recorded by Imam Ahmad and An-Nasai, and At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan.”²¹ ‘We have not heard (the like) of this in the religion of these later days.’¹¹¹ At-Tabari 21:149. *²¹ Ahmad 1:362, An-Nasai in Al-Kubra 6:442, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:99. A few scholars grade this narration weak, including Al-Ama’ut (Al-Musnad no. 3420) and Al-Albani in Da’if Sunan At-Tirmidhi under the Tafsir of this Ayah.

know the consequences of what they say and what they rejected on the Day when they are herded into the fire of Hell. Then Allah points out that He is the One Who is in control of His Creation and Who does whatever He wills, Who gives whatever He wants to whomever He wants, and honors whomever He wants and humiliates whomever He wants, and guides whomever He wants and misguides whomever He wants, and sends the Ruh (Jibril) by His command upon whomsoever He wants among His servants, and seals the hearts of whomever He wants, so no one can guide him apart from Allah. His servants do not possess any power and have no control over His dominion, not even a speck of dust’s weight; they do not possess even a thin membrane over a date stone. Allah says, denouncing them: ‘Or have they the treasures of the mercy of your Lord, the Almighty, the Real Bestower?’ meaning, the Almighty Whose might cannot be overcome, the Bestower Who gives whatever He wills to whomsoever He wills. This Ayah is like the Ayah: ‘Or have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a speck on the back of a

date stone. Or do they envy men for what Allah has given them of His bounty? Then, We had already given the family of Ibrahim the Book and Al-Hikmah, and conferred upon them a great kingdom. Of than were (some) who believed in him, and of than were (some) who averted their faces from him; and enough is Hell for burning (them).} (4:53-55). X jUT i-y- f&A-V iSay : "If you possessed the treasure of the mercy of my Lord (wealth), then you would surely hold back for fear of (being exhausted), and man is ever miserly!"} (17:100).

“ T T* W* r*~” -r- ^ fj- ^r-r ~i~ / “^} jS/jSi ylij ly J— v’j^=> “^1y o) jiji Uy _A->I l Jj U3»» U J<f ty Oi L*J ^ ^jl >j) ?£ S\$ •-U-J ^w> ly 3*0 l*y _A->I ^y> Jj Uai 412 . Before them denied - the people of Nuh; and ‘Ad; and Fir’awn the man of stakes,\$ 413. And Thamiid, and the people of Lilt, and the Dwellers of Al-Aykah; such were the Confederates.} 414. Not one of them but denied the Messengers; therefore My torment was justified.} 415. And these only wait for a single Sayhah there will be no pause or ending thereto.} 416. They say: "Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittand before the Day of Reckoning!"} 417 . Be patient of what they say...} A Reminder of Those Who were destroyed among the Previous Nations Allah tells us about those past nations and the punishment and vengeance that struck them for their going against the Messengers and disbelieving in the Prophets, peace be upon them. We have already seen their stories in detail in numerous places (in the Qur’an). Allah says: 444>- Vf <M\$} 4such were the Confederates.} meaning, they were greater and stronger than you, they had more wealth and children, but that did not protect them from the punishment of Allah at all when the command of your Lord came to pass.’ Allah says: 4Not one of them but denied the Messengers; therefore My torment was justified.}

The reason for their destruction was their disbelief in the Messengers, so let those who are addressed here beware and be afraid.’

jggga vs-,and disbelief, so Allah commanded His .if Messenger & to be7- ; "7^; Messenger jg to be JllXl[lyi^LQ patient in the face of '.y :u their insults, and He gave him the glad tidings that his if Patience would be <-4^ j rewarded with victory and success. ’*! *Vi yc^ ? ?f 314@^5 r3 ^77?- . . ^ ^ i£*K iiSfc; £Z US .^JjAa^aU L.1Jjlj.jiij , r*> t f’, <^<*> .’. •> ^ 417.And remember Our s/fli;e Dawud, endued iUM) wm Al~A he ' ^ ^ - was ever ofl-retummv in Ip ^C/jjolS ^S^cA matters =J repentance.} and in 418. Verily, We made the mountains to glorify Our praises with him in the ‘Asht and Ishraq 419. And (so did) the birds assembled, all obedient to him.} 420. We made his kingdom strong and gave him Al-Hikmah and sound judgement in speech and decision.} Dawud, peace be upon him Allah tells us that His servant and Messenger Dawud, peace be upon him, was endued with power. Al-Ayd means strength in knowledge and action. Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said, “Al-Ayd means strength.”¹¹ At-Tabari 2 1 :166 , 167.

Mujahid said, Al-Ayd means strength in obedience to Allah.” Qatadah said, “Dawud, peace be upon him, was given strength in worship and the proper understanding of Islam.”² He told us that he, peace be upon him, used to spend a third of the night in prayer, and he fasted for half a lifetime. This was reported in the Two Sahihs, where it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said: f*~f > J*»* iijlS vke Ju; 4)1 J j^ili 4^i 1 , p s / (# , , , ^ i aLlj j tj 15 Ojta Sis i\ iij % Yj «77ie mosf beloved of prayer to Allah is the prayer of Dawud, and the most beloved of fasting to Allah is the fasting of Dawud. He used to sleep for half of the night, stand in prayer for a third of the night, then sleep for a

sixth of the night, and he used to fast alternate days. He never fled from the battlefield, and he always turned to Allah, which means that he turned to Allah with regard to all of his affairs. 4 Verily, We made the mountains to glorify Our praises with him in the 'Ashi and Ishraq.} means, Allah caused the mountains to glorify His praises with him at sunrise and at the end of the day. This is like the Ayah: &4 40 you mountains. Glorify (Allah) with him! And you birds (also)!} (34:10). The birds also used to glorify Allah's praises with him. If a bird flew by him and heard him chanting the Zabur, it would not go away; instead it would stay hovering in the air, glorifying Allah along with him. And the lofty mountains would respond to him and echo his glorification of Allah. Ibn Jarir *1 At-Tabari 21:166. 121 At-Tabari 21 :167. *31 Fath Al-B&ri 3 :20, Muslim 2 :8 16

recorded from 'Abdullah bin Al-Harith bin Nawfal that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, did not pray Ad-Duha. ['Abdullah said:] "So I took him to Umm Hani, may Allah be pleased with her, and said to her, Tell him what you told me.' She said, The Messenger of Allah sH entered my house on the day of the conquest of Makkah. He called for water to be poured into a large bowl, then he called for a garment which he used as a screen between me and him, and he washed himself. Then he sprinkled water around the house and prayed eight Rak'ahs. This was Ad-Duha, and its standing, bowing, prostration and sitting were all equal in brevity.' Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, left, saying, I have read the Qur'an from cover to cover, and I never knew about Salat Ad-Duha until now!' Then he recited: i glorify Our praises with him in the 'Ashi and Ishraq.} I used to say, "What is Salat Al-Ishraq, but now I know what it is." i And (so did) the birds assembled,^ meaning, hovering in the air. id} A '\$} i all obedient to him.} means, they obeyed him and followed him in glorifying Allah. Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam and Ibn Zayd: id} A %} i all obedient to him.} means, "Following his commands." *21 it&.ii tiiHj} <\$ We made his kingdom strong} means, *We gave him complete dominion with all that kings need.' Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid said, "He was the strongest and most powerful of the people of this world." [1 * At-Tabari 21:169. ' At-Tabari 21 :169.

321 Surah 38. Sad (21 - 25) (Part-23 422. When they entered in upon Ddwud, he was terrified of them. They said: "Fear not! (We are) two litigants, one of us has wronged the other, therefore judge between us with truth, and treat us not with injustice, and guide us to the right way .4 423 . Verily, this my brother (in religion) has ninety-nine ewes, while I have (only) one ewe, and he says: "Hand it over to me, and he overpowered me in speech."4 424. [Ddwud] said: "He has wronged you in demanding your ewe in addition to his ewes. And, verily, many partners oppress one another, except those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and they are few." And Ddwud guessed that We have tried him and he sought forgiveness of his Lord, and he fell down prostrate and turned (to Allah) in repentance. 425. So, We forgave him that, and verily, for him is a near access to Us, and a good place of return . The Story of the Two Litigants In discussing this passage, the scholars of Tafsir mention a story which is mostly based upon Isrd'iliyat narrations. Nothing has been reported about this from the Infallible Prophet sgg that we could accept as true. But Ibn Abi Hatim narrated a HacLith whose chain of narration cannot be regarded as Sahxh because it is reported by Yazld Ar-Raqashi from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him. Although Yazld was one of the righteous, his Hadiths are regarded as weak by the Imams. So, it is better to speak briefly of this story and refer knowledge of it to Allah, may He be exalted. For the Qur'an is true and what it contains is also true. 4 he was terrified of them. This was because he was in

his Mihrab (private chamber). That was the noblest part of his house, where he commanded that no one should enter upon him that day. So, he did not realize that these two people had climbed the fence surrounding his Mihrab (private chamber) to ask him about their case. 4and he overpowered me in speech. means, *he defeated me.'

a& 4And Dawud guessed that \Ne have tried him 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that this means, "We tested him."111 4and he fell down prostrate and turned (to Allah) in repentance. 4So, Weforgave him that,} The Sajdah in Surah Sad The performance of Sajdah in Surah Sad is not one of the obligatory locations; it is a prostration of thanks (Sajdat Shuki). The evidence for it is the report recorded by Imam Ahmad from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, who said; "The prostration in Surah Sad is not one of the obligatory prostrations; I saw the Messenger of Allah jg prostrating in this Surah. "21 This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasal in his Tafsir. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahib."3 In his Tafsir of this Ayah, An-Nasal also recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Prophet jg prostrated in Sad, and he said: J I La tijjJ j a I Jjta La*1>w'B «Dawud prostrated as an act of repentance and we prostrate as an act of thanks.n" This was recorded only by An-Nasal.141 The men of its chain of narration are all reliable. In his Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Al- 'Awwam said that he asked Mujahid about the prostration in Surah Sad. He said, 1 asked Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased At-Tabari 21 :181. Ahmad 1 :359. 131 Fath Al-B&ri 2 :643 , Abu Dawud 2 :123 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3 :176 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :342 141 An-Nasal 2:159.

323Surah 38. Sad (21 - 25) (Part-23 with him, 'Why do you prostrate?' He said, 'Have you not read: *?)> iartd among his [Null's] progeny Dawud, Sulaymdn^ (6:84) iThey are those whom Allah had guided. So fallow their guidance} (6:90). Dawud, peace be upon him, was one of those whom your Prophet was commanded to follow. Dawud prostrated here so the Messenger of Allah jg also prostrated here." Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg recited Sad while he was on the Minbar. When he reached the prostration, he came down from the Minbar and prostrated, and the people prostrated with him. On another occasion when he recited it, he reached the prostration and the people prepared to prostrate. He jg said: "'Iff Zji Ujj» iThis is repentance far a Prophet, but I see that you are preparing to prostrate .» Then he came down (from the Minbar) and prostrated."2 This was recorded only by Abu Dawud and its chain of narration meets the conditions of the Two Sahihs. iand verily, far him is a near access to Us, and a good place of (final) return .} means, on the Day of Resurrection, he will have good deeds by virtue of which he will be brought close to Allah, and he will have a good place of (final) return, which means the lofty levels of Paradise, because of his repentance and his perfect justice in his kingdom. As it says in the Sahih. 'ofaJu j,jji 4,,i; 111 Path Al-Bari 8 :405 . * Abu Dawud no. 1410. jjMJP *jLj jt

324 Tafslr Ibtt Kathir "Those who are fair and just with their families and those who are under their authority will be on Minbars of light on the right hand of Ar-Rahman, and both His Hands are right Hands u* gp ijji j Ai-ii- 111 4^0^ fj>_ !>-* P v'-*e ji' 0* Ojfcw £0 oj0 426. O Dawud! Verily, We have placed you as a successor on the earth; so judge you between men in truth (and justice) and follow not your desire -for it will mislead you from the path of Allah. Verily, those who wander astrayfrom the path of Allah (shall) have a severe tonnent, because they forgot the Day of Reckoning .) Advice to

Rulers and Leaders This is advice from Allah, may He be exalted, to those who are in positions of authority. They should rule according to the truth and justice revealed from Him, they should not turn away from it and be led astray from the path of Allah. Allah has issued a stern warning of a severe punishment to those who go astray from His path and forget the Day of Resurrection. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibrahim Abu Zur'ah, who read the Scripture, reported that Al-Walid bin 'Abd Al-Malik said to him: "Does anyone have the right to question the Khalifah? You have read the first Scripture and the Qur'an, and you have understood them." He replied, "May I speak, O Commander of the faithful?" He said, "Speak, for you are under the protection of Allah." I said, "O Commander of the faithful, are you more dear to Allah, or Dawud, peace be upon him? For Allah gave him both prophethood and rulership, then He warned him in His Book: *o6 Qp Jeji ill 4<i' 3^ 40 Dawud ! Verily, We have placed you as a successor on the earth; so judge you between men in truth (and justice) and follow not your desire - for it will mislead you from the path of Allah).*" *m Muslim 3 : 1458.*

*nJ == ^==7^=^m tiOj^Lk;l.^,l*j b 'biU-l^j i r f "'S. ' "\1 < > » *"1 j^vX psssjfi (P"C I <"•" *"> is the Guide to the Truth. Ikrimah said: 4(Those shall) have a severe torment, because they forgot the Day of Reckoning.> "They will have a severe punishment on*

*the Day of Reckoning because of what they forgot."*¹¹ ' As-Suddi said, "They will have a severe punishment because of what they neglected to do for the sake of the Day of Reckoning. "¹² ' This interpretation is more in accordance with the apparent meaning of the Ayah. And Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, *j^Cti omIJI 3**? -X cJf>Vi j c*>*Lfa)(\J^fj .lyjil Jjm£ ^ f \M 4& ^27. And We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire!*⁴²⁸. Shall We treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds as those who cause mischief on the earth? Or shall We ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 21:189. At-Tabari 21:189.

³²⁶ Tafsir Ibn Kathir treat those who have Taqwa as the evildoers?} ⁴²⁹. (This is) a Book which We have sent down to you, full of blessings, that they may ponder over its Verses, and that men of understanding may remember The Wisdom behind the Creation of This World Allah tells us that He did not create the creatures in vain; He created them to worship Him Alone, then He will gather them on the Day of Gathering and will reward the obedient and punish the disbelievers. Allah says: ⁴And We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve!} meaning, those who do not think that the resurrection and the place of return will occur, but they think that there is nothing after this world. ^{4jp^ !\$ oM 4}Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire! ^{fy} means, woe to them on the Day when they will be resurrected, from the Fire that is prepared for them. Then Allah explains that because of His justice and wisdom, He does not treat the believers and the disbelievers equally. Allah says: ^{J Jljif 4}Shall We treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds as those who do mischief on the earth? Or shall We treat Those who have Taqwa as the evildoers?} meaning, *We shall not do that.' They are not equal before Allah, and since this is the case, there must inevitably be another realm in which those who obey Allah will be rewarded and the wicked will be punished. This teaching indicates to those of a sound mind and upright nature that there must inevitably be a resurrection and recompense. We see evildoers and criminals are prospering and increasing in wealth, children and luxury, until they die in that state. We see

oppressed believers dying of grief and distress, so by the wisdom of the All-Wise, All-Knowing, All-Just who does not do even a speck of dust's weight of injustice, there should be a time when the rights of the oppressed are restored with due justice. If this does not happen in this world, there must be another realm where recompense may be made and consolation may be found. The Qur'an teaches sound aims based on a rational way of thinking, so Allah says: 4(Tin's is) a Book which We have sent down to you, full of blessings, that they may ponder over its Ayat, and that men of understanding may remember.} meaning, those who are possessed of wisdom and reason. Ini* ,Ji£» de ^ Jj JS 0* JS\$ V**" 9* 3"" 430. And to Ddwud We gave Sulaymdn. How excellent a servant! Verily, he was ever turning in repentance (to Us)!} 433. When there were displayed before him, in the afternoon, well trained horses of the highest breed.} 432 . He said : "I did love the good instead of remembering my Lord," till the time was over, and (the sun) had hidden in the veil (ofnight).} 433. Then he said: "Bring them back to me." Then he began to pass his hand over their legs and their necks.} Sulayman the Son of Dawud Allah tells us that he gave Sulayman to Dawud as a Prophet, as He says elsewhere: ^pf} }And Sulayman inherited Dawud} (27:1). meaning, he inherited prophethood from him. Dawud had other sons besides Sulayman, for he had one hundred free wives. 44>*^ -V*!' p*;}

iHow excellent a servant! Verily, he was ever oft-returning in repentance (to Us)!\$ This is praise for Sulayman, because he was very much obedient, worshipping Allah much and always turning to Allah in repentance. iWhen there were displayed before him, in the afternoon, well trained horses of the highest breed .} means, these well trained horses were shown to Sulayman, peace be upon him, in his capacity as king and ruler. Mujahid said, "They were the kind of horses which stand on three legs and raise the fourth, and they were swift horses. ,1) This was also the view of several others among the Salaf. Abu Dawud recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg came back from the campaign of Tabuk or Khaybar, and there was a curtain covering her room. The wind came and lifted the curtain, revealing some toys belonging to 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her. The Prophet jg said: U iJu U» uWhat is this, O 'A'ishah?v She, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "My toys." Among them he saw a horse with two wings made of cloth. He 5g\$ said: '-i* U» «What is this that I see in the midst of them ?» She, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "A horse." The Messenger of Allah ag said, (^jJl IJu U "Arid ivhat is this on it?v She, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "Wings." The Messenger of Allah jg said, • <J (yjjj »A horse with two wings?> She, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "Did you not hear that Sulayman, peace be upon him, m At-Tabari 21:192, 193.

had a horse that had wings?" She, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "The Messenger of Allah 3g| smiled so broadly that I could see his molars." '-d'y &- * iSS ££3 &} 4He said: "I did love the good (i.e., horses) instead of remembering my Lord" till the time was over, and (the sun) had hidden in the veil (ofnight)} More than one of the Salaf and scholars of Tafsir mentioned that he was so busy looking at the horses that he missed the time of 'Asr prayer. He did not miss it deliberately, but because of forgetfulness, as happened to the Prophet sg on the day of Khandaq, when he was too busy to pray 'Asr and he prayed it after the sun had set. This was recorded in the Two Sahihs with more than one chain of narration, including the report from Jabir, may Allah be pleased with him, who said, "On the day of Khandaq, TJmar, may Allah be pleased with him, came after the sun had set and started cursing the disbelievers of the Quraysh. He said, 'O Messenger of Allah, I could not pray 'Asr until the sun had almost set.' The Messenger of Allah jg said, I U 4)1j> aBy Allah, I did not pray it either. He (Jabir)

said, "So we got up and went to Buthan. Allah's Prophet sg performed ablution for the prayer and we too performed ablution. He prayed 'Asr after the sun had set, then he prayed Maghrib after that."*21 iThen he said: "Bring them (horses) back to me." Then he began to pass his hand over their legs and their necks.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, "He said, 'No, by Allah, you will not keep me from worshipping my Lord again,' then he ordered that they should be slaughtered."13 ' This was also the view of Qatadah. As-Suddi said, "Their necks and hamstrings were Abu Dawud 5:227. '2| FathAl-Bari 2:82, Muslim 1 :438. 131 At-Tabari 21 :195.

struck with swords." 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "He began patting the horses' heads and legs out of love for them."12* This is the view that was favored by Ibn Jarir. He said, "Because he would not punish an animal by cutting its hamstrings or destroy his own wealth for no other reason than that he had been distracted from his prayer by looking at it, and it was not the animals' fault." This view which Ibn Jarir thought more correct is subject to further review, because such action may have been permissible according to their law, especially since he got angry for the sake of Allah for being distracted by these horses until the time for prayer had lapsed. Then, since he dispensed with them for the sake of Allah, Allah compensated him with something better, the wind which blew gently by his order wherever he willed. Its morning lasted a month's (journey), and its afternoon lasted a month's (journey). This was faster and better than horses. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Qatadah and Abu Ad- Dahma', who traveled a lot to the Kaljah, said, "We met a man from among the bedouins who said to us: The Messenger of Allah jg took my hand and started teaching me some of that which Allah had taught him. He said, 'Si5" J^r'j 3^ dlktl N) JUi <SiI JUll Illi V JiJp 'You do not give up anything for the sake of Allah, but Allah will give you something better than if.t'"*3 434. And indeed, We tried Sulayman and We placed on his throne Jasad (a body), and he returned. At-Jabari 21 : 195. At-Tabari 21 :196. * Ahmad 5 :78

331Surah 38. Sad (34 - 40) (Part-23 435. He said: "My Lord! Forgive me, and bestow upon me a kingdom such as shall not belong to any other after me. Verily, You are the Bestower.") 436. So, We subjected to him the wind; it blew gently by his order wherever he willed,4 437. And the ShayatTn, from every kind ofbuilder and diver, 438. And also others bound in fetters. 439. [Allah said to Sulayman] : "This is Our gift, so spend you or withhold, no account will be asked ofyou."4 440. And verily, for him is a near access to Us, and a good (final) rehtm.)

How Allah tested Sulayman then made Things easy for

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4916-4939]

Him Allah says, 4£ii £3 2&) 4And indeed, We tried Sulayman) meaning, *We tested him.' 4&X 4and We placed on his throne Jasad (a body))) 4vti }) 4and he returned.) means, after this test, he turned back to Him and asked for forgiveness and to be given a kingdom such as shall not belong to any other after him. 4rg;4.iiij)'d 4He said: "My Lord! Forgive me, and bestow upon me a kingdom such as shall not belong to any other after me. Verily, You are the Bestowcr.") I1 ' Allah does not explain exactly what this Jasad was which He placed on his throne. We believe that Allah tested him by placing this Jasad on his throne, even though we do not know what it was. Everything that has been said concerning it has

been taken from the Isr&'Uiyat, and we do not know what is true. (Since the word means "corporeal" interpretations centered around some form of Jinn.) Allah knows best.

332 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Some of them said, "No one after me will have the right to ask Allah for such a kingdom." This is the apparent meaning from the context of the Ayah, and several Hadiths with a similar meaning have been narrated from the Messenger of Allah In his Tafsir of this Ayah, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet ﷺ said: 'An Ifrit from among the Jinn came and bothered me last night- or he said something similar -Trying to stop me from praying. Allah enabled me to overpower him, and I wanted to tie him to one of the pillars in the Masjid so that you could see him this morning. Then I remembered what my brother Sulayman said, 'My Lord! Forgive me and bestow upon me a kingdom such as shall not belong to any other after me}'» Rawh said, "so he let him go, humiliated." »! This was also recorded by Muslim and An-Nasai. 121 In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Abu Ad-Darda', may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah stood up to pray and we heard him say, 'I seek refuge with Allah from you.' » Then he said, 'I curse you with the curse of Allah.' » three times, and he stretched out his hand as if he was reaching out to take something. When he finished his prayer, we said, 'O Messenger of Allah, we heard you say something in your prayer which we have never heard you say before, and we saw you stretching out your hand.' He ﷺ said: 111 Fath At-Bari 1 :660. Muslim 1 :384, An-Nasai in Al-Kubra 6 :443.

11 The enemy of Allah Iblis came with a flame of fire to throw in my face, so I said, "I seek refuge with Allah from you" three times, then I said, "I curse you with the complete curse of Allah," but he did not back off. I said it three times. Then I wanted to seize him . By Allah, if it were not for the words of our brother Sulayman, he would have been chained up and he would have become a plaything for the children of the people of Al-Madinah. n" 11 Allah says: 'We subjected to him the wind; it blew gently by his order wherever he willed. Al-Hasan Al-Basri, may Allah have mercy on him, said, "When Sulayman, peace be upon him, slaughtered the horses out of anger for the sake of Allah, Allah compensated him with something better and swifter, the wind whose morning was a month's (journey), and its afternoon was a month's (journey)." 121 iC 4 wherever he willed. \$ means, wherever in the world he wanted. 4 -^0?!^ } & \$ i And also the Shayatin, from every kind of builder and diver means, among them were some whom he used to build high rooms, images, basins as large as reservoirs, and cauldrons fixed (in their places), and other difficult tasks which humans were unable to do. And there was another group, who dived into the sea recovering pearls, jewels and other precious things l 1 * Muslim 1 :385. 121 At-Tabari 21 :201.

which cannot be found anywhere else. i And also others bound in fetters .} means, tied up in chains. These were the ones who had rebelled and refused to work, or else their work was bad and they were wrongdoers. i [Allah said to Sulayman] : "This is Our Gift, so spend you or withhold, no account will be asked of you." } means, "this that We have given to you of kingship and perfect power, as you asked for, you may give to whomsoever you wish and deny to whomsoever you wish, and you will not be brought to account. Whatever you do is permissible for you, so however you judge, it will be right.' It was

reported in the Two Sahihs that when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was given the choice between being a servant and a Messenger - who does what he is commanded to do and distributes things among the people as Allah commands him to do - or being a Prophet and a king, who can give to whomever he wishes and withhold from whomever he wishes without being held accountable for anything, he chose the former. He consulted with Jibril, peace be upon him, who said, "Be humble." So he chose the former because it has a greater value before Allah and brings a higher status in the Hereafter, even though the second option, prophethood combined with kingship, is also a great thing both in this world and in the Hereafter, when Allah tells us what He gave to Sulayman, peace be upon him, in this world, He tells us that he will have a great share with Allah on the Day of Resurrection. He says: *And verily, for him is a near access to Us, and a good (final) return.* meaning, in this world and the Hereafter. if lift illl jiy Isti CjQ 1>-U6 \j} ji-J "if Jfi l!» AJ-J lij CLy 4 if, <iju^

441 . And remember Our servant Ayyub, when he invoked his Lord (saying): "Verily, Shaytan has afflicted me with distress and torment!" } 42 . (Allah said to him) : "Strike the ground with your foot. This is (a spring of) water to wash in, cool and a drink." } 443. And We gave him (back) his family, and along with than the like thereof, as a mercy from Us, and a reminder for those wlv understand.} 444. "And take in your Ixand a bundle of thin grass and strike there- with (your wife), and break not your oath." Truly, We found him patient. How excellent a servant! Verily, he was ever oft-rehoming in repentance (to Us)!} Ayyub Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Ayyub (Job) and how He tested him. These tests afflicted his body, his wealth and his children, until there was no part of his body that was healthy except his heart. Then he had nothing left in this world which he could use to help him deal with his sickness or the predicament he was in, besides his wife, who retained her devotion to him because of her faith in Allah and His Messenger. She used to work for people as a paid servant, and she fed and served him (Ayyub) for nearly eighteen years. Before that, he was very rich and had many children, being i&'&i ton ^ 4 If . \ d li&iS /• f > * •> ' ' .

well off in worldly terms. All of that had been taken away until he ended up being thrown into the city dump where he stayed all this time, shunned by relatives and strangers alike, with the exception of his wife - may Allah be pleased with her. She did not leave him, morning and evening, except for when she was serving people, then she would come straight back to him. When this had gone on for a long time, and things had gotten very bad, and the time allotted by divine decree had come to an end, Ayyub prayed to the Lord of the worlds, the God of the Messengers, and said: t} iVerily, distress has seized me, and You are the Most Merciful of all those who show mercy\$ (21:83). And according to this Ayah: iAnd remember Our servant Ayyub, wlien he invoked his Lord (saying): "Verily, Shaytan has afflicted me with distress and torment!" } It was said that "distress" referred to bodily afflictions and "torment" referred to the loss of his wealth and children. Then the Most Merciful of those who show mercy responded to him, telling him to stand up and strike the ground with his foot. He did this, and Allah caused a spring of water to flow. He commanded him to wash in it, and all the pain and affliction in his body disappeared. Then He commanded him to strike the ground in a different place, and Allah caused another spring to flow, and Ayyub was commanded to drink from it. Then all his internal problems disappeared, and he became healthy again, inside and out. Allah says: c>r,- - : gft istrike the ground with yourfoot. Tins is (a spring of) water to wash in, cool and a (refreshing) drink.} Ibn Jarir and Ibn

Abi Hatim recorded that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: *أَجِئُوا بِاللَّيْلِ أَوْ بِالنَّهَارِ* 14; *جاءكم رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم في ليلة الجمعة*

X>-1 Oil La Lai v >y_ I s ji t JLil <b!_j Jti ! O^-LuzJ L>aJl>- 1 Jlii U '<ii lu>: J ^ui ili : Jii ?iiii Uj Si jvs 5^1 aIIa i-jjjf JUti t<J »iiJi J JI L-t_> L*Ti l 5i ^1L>-^JI Jp 'jA c^S \ J>-j 3*^ J 3i* L« V ^fZ3j 2»i M u4i£ ^ Jj tJu5 ai ji^Jd jUjB o-Lj 4j!^ai o*\$w*t LaLuij lili i £>-l>- ^lj J IS"j ! ijlj i V) ^3L*J JI iijlj - oijl (_s>-jt^ v l^lip ILljI oLS j15 lUls t^Lo [*I8] 4@^j ££&^ o\ sS^Ji Uli tj£ li Jp ;^3l j-; 5; U Jil LUiji jjj Lglip JIiti U JI)j Jp july a JiiliJl iJLi 4il '3A'j uijLi <fcl ijtt J;! :<i-Jli «Jlj Si ilSj :Jli a}£ u{ Jii : J15 ,UL^> Sis' SI ill. * Zl\ ^3 oJij 1^114 Uli Jus Sii IsA tJrfiy 3^3^ 3xi : ji33if jjj! ^ ei>^ 1 C-p3^J t IS J>- o-kiiijl o C^3ii j-lji Jp *a>U «Allah's Prophet Ayyub, peace be upon him, suffered for eighteen years from his affliction and was shunned by relatives and strangers alike, besides two men who were the closest of his brothers to him. They used to visit him every morning and every evening. One of them said to his companion, "You know, by Allah, that Ayyub committed a great sin which nobody in the world ever committed." His companion said, "Why are you saying that?" He said, "For eighteen years he has been suffering and Allah has not had mercy on him and relieve his suffering." When he went to him the next morning, the (second) man could not wait to tell this to Ayyub. Ayyub, peace be upon him, said, "I do not know what you are talking about, but Allah knows if I passed by two men who were arguing and they mentioned the Name of Allah, I would go back home and offer expiation lest they had mentioned the Name of Allah in an improper manner." Whenever he went out to answer the call of nature, when he finished, his wife would take his hand until he came back home. One day he took a long time, and Allah had revealed to Ayyub, ^Strike the ground

339 Surah 38. Sad (41 - 44) (Part-23) themselves back to life, and added others like them." 111 Zj) {as a mercy from Us,) means, in return for his patience, steadfastness, repentance, humility and constant turning to Allah. <M'Vf jJj j) {and a reminder for those who understand.) means, for those who understand that the consequence of patience is a solution and a way out. * ^ —' 1 j i - * * -ij. {And take in your hand a bundle of thin grass and strike therewith (your wife), and break not your oath.) Ayyub, peace be upon him, got angry with his wife and was upset about something she had done, so he swore an oath that if Allah healed him, he would strike her with one hundred blows. When Allah healed him, how could her service, mercy, compassion and kindness be repaid with a beating? So Allah showed him a way out, which was to take a bundle of thin grass, with one hundred stems, and hit her with it once. Thus he fulfilled his oath and avoided breaking his vow. This was the solution and way out for one who had Taqwa of Allah and turned to Him in repentance. Allah says: {Truly, We found him patient. How excellent a servant! Verily, he was ever oft-returning in repentance (to Us)!} Allah praised and commanded him, saying, {How excellent a servant! Verily, he was ever oft-returning in repentance (to Us)!} Allah says: O & [ii At-Tabari 21 :212.

& fe. 1 lly 4 And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out (from every difficulty). And He will provide him from (sources) he never could imagine. And whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him. Verily, Allah will accomplish his purpose. Indeed Allah has set a measure for all things. (65:2-3) tjil kx* JQj} iyt £~^ J : »* tv- kx Cpij 4% IK 445. And remember Our servants, Ibrahim, Ishaq, and Ya'qub, Ulil-Aydi wal-Absdr. 4 446. Verily, We did choose them by granting them the remembrance of the Abode.} 447. And they are with Us, verily, of the chosen and the

best!} 448. And remember Isma'il, Al-Yasa', and Dhul-Kifl, all are among the best.} 449. This is a Reminder...} The Chosen and the Best among the Prophets Allah tells us about the virtues of His servants the Messengers and His Prophets: 4 < dj iP'-b 4And remember Our servants, Ibrahim, Ishaq, and Ya'qub, Ulil-Aydi wal-Absdr.} meaning, righteous deeds, beneficial knowledge, strength in worship and insight. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: 4*s£h JJ} 4Ulil-Aydi} "Of great strength and worship; 4^jlj}

iwal-Absar means, understanding of the religion."111 Qatadah and As-Suddi said, "They were given strength in worship and understanding of the religion." }Verily, We did choose them by granting them the remembrance of the Abode .} Mujahid said, "This means: We made them strive for the Hereafter, and there is nothing else for them besides that."121 As-Suddi also said, "The remembrance of the Hereafter and striving for it."131 Malik bin Dinar said, "Allah removed the love of this world from their hearts, and singled them out for land remembrance of the Hereafter." Qatadah said, "They used to remind the people about the Abode of the Hereafter and to strive for it.">41 f.'v ,jgfi I.. \ijcp ^^} }And they are with Us, verily, of the chosen and the best!} means, they are among those who have been elected and chosen, and they are the best and the chosen ones. 4 A-,^ irt Si fSS 'b 4And remember lsmd'il, Al-Yasa' , and Dhul-Kifl, all are among the best.} We have already discussed their characteristics and stories in detail in Surat Al-Anbiya', may peace be upon them, and there is no need to repeat it here. 4^ &*} iThis is a Reminder} means, a reminder to those who will be reminded. As-Suddi said, "This means the Holy Qur'an."151 jjfeA Ifj 40%, 'x* C^o*. w> At-Tabari 21 :215. At-Tabari 21 :218. At-Tabari 21 :218. At-Tabari 21 :217. At-Tabari 2 :220 JuuiU)^S== ' S&A

342 TafsTr Ibn KathTr oi \$ £ *ji £4 449. And verily, for those who have Taqwd is a good final return.} 450. 'Adn Paradise, whose doors will be openedfor them.} 451. Therein they will recline; therein they will call for fruits in abundance and drinks;} 452 . And beside them will be Qasirat-at-Tarf, (and) of equal ages.} 453. This it is what you are promised for the Day of Reckoning!} 454. (It will be said to them)! Verily, this is Our provision which will neverfinish.} The Final Return ofthe Blessed Allah tells us that His blessed, believing servants will have a good final return in the Hereafter, which means their ultimate destination. Then He explains it further, as He says: 4'Adn Gardens} meaning, eternal gardens (of Paradise), 4whose doors will be opened for them.} means, when they come to them (these gardens), their gates will open for them. 4Tlterein they will recline;} It was said that this means that they will sit cross-legged on chairs beneath canopies. oj*} * 4therein they will callforfruits in abundance} means, whatever they ask for, they will find it, and it will be prepared just as they wanted it. 4and drinks;} means, whatever kind of drink they want, the servants will bring it to them,

4 if lioCl) cups, and jugs, and a glass offlowing wine.} (56:18). 4<j\$l L<sJi fas} iAnd beside them will be Qdsirat-at-Tarf (chastefemales)} means, they restrain their glances from anyone except their husbands, and do not turn to anyone else. i(and) of equal ages.} means, they will all be of the same age. This is the understanding of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka*b and As-Suddi.111 4This it is what you are promisedfor the Day ofReckoning!} means, This thatWe have mentioned of the features of Paradise is what He has prepared for His pious servants who will reach it after they have been resurrected from their graves and been saved from the Fire.'Then Allah tells us that Paradise will never come to an end or disappear or cease to be. He says:

iVerily, this is Our provision which will never finish.} This is like the Ayat. 49^ x* £j jJlj jx iWhatever is with you, will be exhausted, and whatever is with Allah will remain} (16:96). 4 jv. £!£} ia gift without an end.} (1 1:108) 4for them is a reward that will never come to an end.} (84:25). 4# UJX\ Jijj j\$T m At-Tabari 21 :223.

344 Tafsir lbn Katlnr tLZilZ toy ,>/• Av /•< »/v _ 'Is S * // ///#! \$ \$Jsi &5liii® o£J£i» aJOiJuj.IvjI, Ii^ p^lis-a ^S-Wl^i>»^oTjJ^ ydjOrJ>4j^l^ AJuJi-fljU ^jjJlj^J*) »J^ (jJtiiiUJG^poyLicj^y^^kiliijjJla^pc/jJl lilj^djli |*p 0kyJi3'{£i&0 :10cz&f&ft ^ 4its provision is eternal and so is its shade; this is the end of those who have Taqwa, and the end (final destination) of the disbelievers is Fire.}(13:35). And there are many similar Ayat. d^&' jfi~* pr) (*£ ^y4 y 2 J: &.* & & tjs tfis i|:~i jii tl^2 ifae iijj ilia 0 pJLS v u u ij£j j.S^di' 4 liL. >i>' '-y r fjf ^Jju Lj VI**; Cf/ / >«? . ; < •< ii •" / / x rt> . - < •# •>./ . * s < <t • •>'•" / tv /<•/ 2 UcS» & c %*- 4~ •jljXb IjIA ,<£s crt » 'll r*~ e* 1x4 '4£+ £*3' 455. This is so! And for the Tdglun will be an evil final return.^ 456. Hell! Where they will enter it, and worst (indeed) is that place to rest!} 457. This is so! Then let them taste it - Hamim and Ghassaq.} 458 . And other of similar kind - all together!} 459. This is a troop altering with you (in Hell), tw welcome for them! Verily, they shall enter in the Fire!} 460. (The followers will say to those who misled): "Nay, you (too)! No welcomefor you! It is you who brought this upon us, so evil is this place to stay in!"}

461. They will say: "Our Lord! Wlwever brought this upon us, add to him a double torment in the Fire!"4 462. And they will say: "What is the matter with us that we see not men whom we used to count among the bad ones?"} 463. "Did we take them as an object of mockery, or have (our) eyes failed to perceive them?"} 464. Verily, that is the very truth - the mutual dispute of the people of the Fire!} The Final Return ofthe Doomed Having mentioned the final of the blessed, Allah follows that with mention of the final return of the doomed when they are resurrected and brought to account. Allah says: 4This is so! And for the Taghin}, which refers to those who disobey Allah, may He be glorified, and oppose the Messengers ofAllah, peace be upon them, 4will be an evil final return.} means, the worst fined return. Then Allah explains it by saying, 4hiell! Where they will enter} means, they will enter it and it will overwhelm them on all sides. 4and worst (indeed) is that place to rest! This is so! Then let them taste it - Hamim and Ghassaq.} Hamim is something that has been heated to the ultimate degree, and Ghassaq is the opposite, something that is so intensely cold that it is unbeeirable. Allah says: 4And other of similar kind (opposite pairs) - all together!} means, and other things of this kind, a thing and its opposite, serving as punishments. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, concerning the Ayah:

4And of/ier o/ similar kind - all together!} "Different kinds of punishments." 1 11 Others said, such as intense cold and intense heat, and drinking Hamim and eating the bitter tree of Az- Zaqquq, and being lifted up and thrown down, and other kinds of paired opposites, all ofwhich are means ofpunishment. The Disputes ofthe People ofHell 477ns is a troop altering with you (in Hell), no welcome for them! Verily, they shall enter in the Fire!} Here Allah tells us what the people of Hell will say to one another. This is like the Ayah 4lji£-! iil {jf} iEvery time a new nation enters, it curses its sister nation (that went before)} (7:38), which means, instead of greeting one another, they will curse one another, accuse one another of being liars and reject one another. When a new group arrives, the keepers of Hell will say, ijJli |^il U-j* y \X*} 4Thi\$ is a troop altering with you (in Hell), no welcome for them! Verily, they shall enter in the Fire!} meaning, because they are of the people of Hell. }Nay, you (too)! No welcome for

you!} means, those who are coming in will say, 4Q 0X& *0 \$} }Nay, you (too)! No welcome for you! It is you who brought this upon us,} meaning, "you called us to that which led us to this fate." IM At-Tabari 21 :230.

iso evil is this place to stay in!} means, evil is this abode and this destination. ^ »j>jtil' j U0% (Sjc tlji Uiti U fj_j ,j* Gy iThey will say: "Our Lord! Whoever brought this upon us, add to him a double torment in the Fire!"). This is like the Ayah, *-**-*? ?f\ Jii Gy *156^ 4 jpj <77ie /«sf o/ them will say to the first of them : "Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire." He will say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you know not."} (7:38), which means that each of them will be punished as he deserves. »/ • r,r A r • 'K~S\ «£» cites ' -or they will say : "What is the matter with us that we see not men whom we used to count among the bad ones? Did we take them as an object of mockery, or have (our) eyes failed to perceive them?"} Here Allah tells us that when they are in Hell, the disbelievers will notice that they do not see people who they thought were misguided, while they thought of themselves as believers. They will say, "why do we not see them with us in the Fire?" Mujahid said, "This is what Abu Jahl will say; he will say, "what is the matter with me that I do not see Bilal and 'Ammar and Suhayb and so-and-so... This is an example; all the disbelievers are like this, they think that the believers will go to Hell, sowhen the disbelievers enter Hell, they will wonder why they do not see them there, and they will say, IM At-Tabari 21 :232

349Surah 38. Sad (65 - 70) (Part-23 466. "The Lord of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them, the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving."} 467. Say : "That is a great news,"} 468. "From which you turn away!"} 469. "I had no knowledge of the chiefs (angels) on high when they were disputing and discussing."} 470. "Only this has been revealed to me, that I am a plain wamer."} The Message ofthe Messenger^ is a Great News Allah tells His Messenger sg to say to those who disbelieved in Allah, associated others in worship with Him and denied His Messenger: 1 am a wamer, I am not as you claim.' i'JP3\$ % i i Cj} 4and there is no God (worthy of worship) except Allah, the One, the Irresistible,} means, He Alone has subjugated and controlled everything. J*H\3 ^ 4The Lord of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them,} means, He is the Sovereign of all that and is in control of it. 4the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving.} means, He is Oft-Forgiving as well as being Almighty and All-Powerful. 4Say: "That (this Qur'an) is a great news,"} means, 'something very important, which is that Allah has sent me to you. 4From which you turn away!} means, "you neglect it.' it h Pi & a&& 41 had no knowledge of the chiefs (angels) on high when they were

350 Tafstr Tbn Kathlr mm ijXjlZ f|pJyV^lj j15 g» 1 V^P^ujlij iftlil4ii_LcS^JL I J^_- sa i^ jia) liC\ 1 JJ, ^aeisp Si deputing and discussing. meaning, "were it not for the divine revelation, how could I have known about the dispute of the chiefs on high (the angels)?" This refers to their dispute concerning Adam, peace be upon him, and how Iblls refused to prostrate to him and argued with his Lord because He preferred him (Adam) over him. This is what Allah says: /~/ <4 3li i)) y, * n'.< /0 j^*AJ (J~X) o* ££ Pi @Swp S4.i % ly^X \$ psill Sju 1&. Q &3 J jJiZ £ JM. U '& J&l % ^ ft &Z 3u o* &£j / <*^ %% ft ju ft) *4* j® -iX ft' 'i'J -Ml ft} Lift' \$Ui jl! j#. &Cp^@SuirI jli 4®£ \$03\$# pf> 471. (Remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Truly, I am going to create manfrom clay."} 472. "So, when I have fashioned him and breathed into him (his) soul created by Me, then you fall down prostrate to him."}

473. So, the angels prostrated themselves, all of them, 474. Except Iblis, he was proud and was one of the disbelievers .4 475. (Allah) said: "O Iblis! What prevents you from prostrating yourself to one whom I have created with Both My Hands. Are you too proud or are you one of the high exalted?" 476. [Iblis] said: "I am better than he. You created me from fire, and You created him from clay."4 477. (Allah) said: "Then get out from here; for verily, you are outcast."4 478. "And verily, My curse is on you till the Day of Recompense."4 479. [Iblis] said: "My Lord! Give me then respite till the Day the (dead) are resurrected."4 480. (Allah) said : "Verily, you are of those allowed respite,"4 481. "Till the Day of the time appointed."4 482. [Iblis] said: "By Your might, then I will surely mislead them all,"4 483. "Except Your true servants amongst them."4 484. (Allah) said: "The truth is - the truth I say - "4 485. "That I will fill Hell with you and those of them (mankind) that follow you, together."4 The Story of Adam and Iblis Allah mentions this story in Surat Al-Baqarah, at the beginning of Surat Al-A'raf in Surat Al-Hijr, Al-tsra', Al-Kahf and here. Before creating Adam, peace be upon him, Allah told the angels that He was going to create a human being from sounding clay of altered smooth black mud. He told them that when He finished creating and forming him, they were to prostrate to him as a sign of honor and respect, and out of obedience to the command of Allah, may He be exalted. All of the angels obeyed this command except for Iblis, who was not one of them. He was one of the Jinn, and his nature betrayed him at his time of greatest need. He refused to prostrate to Adam, and he disputed with his Lord about him, claiming that

352 Tafslr Ibn Kathir he was better than Adam, because he was created from fire while Adam was created from clay, and fire was better than clay, or so he said. He made a mistake by doing this, and he went against the command of Allah, thus committing the sin of disbelief. So Allah exiled him, humiliated him, and cast him out of His mercy and His sacred Presence, and called him "Iblis" symbolizing that he had Ablasa min Ar-Rahmah (despaired of mercy) - that there was no hope for him of mercy. He cast him down from the heavens, disgraced and rejected, to the earth. Iblis asked Allah to give him a reprieve until the Day of Resurrection, so the Forbearing One, Who does not hasten to punish those who disobey Him, gave him a reprieve. When he knew that he was safe from destruction until the Day of Resurrection, he rebelled and transgressed. \$[Iblis] said: "By Your might, then I will surely mislead them all, except Your true servants amongst them."} This is like the Ayat i[Iblis] said : "See this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite until the Day of Resurrection, I will surely seize and mislead his offspring all but a few!"} (17:62). These few are the ones who are excepted in another Ayah, which is: liijj* ,, a'lt l .. >(fp ,^41 iSiGp iVerily, My servants - you have no authority over them. And All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian.) (17:65) i(Allah) said: "The truth is - and the truth I say that I will fill Hell with you and those of them (mankind) that follow you, together."} Some of them, including Mujahid, read this as meaning, "I am the Truth and the truth I say." According to another report narrated from Mujahid, it means, "The truth is from Me and I

speak the truth." Others, such as As-Suddi, interpreted it as being an oath sworn by Allah.¹²¹ This Ayah is like the Ayat &£& oJ&SiV lit Jjil' o*- the Word from Me took effect, that I will fill Hell with Jinn and mankind together.) (32:13), and i(Allah) said: "Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all) - an ample recompense." (17:63). •G Si "^1 j» o) 0 ty jt tfc. C JLw 486. Say: "No wage do I ask of you for this, nor am I one of the Mutakallifin ."4 487. "It is only a Reminder for all the creatures."4 488. "And you shall certainly know the truth of it after a while."}

Allah says: ‘Say, O Muhammad, to these idolators: I do not ask you to give me any reward from the goods of this world in return for the Message which I convey to you and the sincere advice I offer.’
 4<S& j. ia 4nor am I one of the Mutakallifin .} means, ‘and I do not add anything to that which Allah has told me. Whatever I am commanded to do, I do it, and I do not add anything or take anything away. By doing this I am seeking the Face of Allah and the Hereafter.’ Sufyan Ath-Thawri, narrated from Al-A‘mash and MansOr from Abu Ad-Duha that Masruq said, “We went to ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud, may Allah be pleased with him. He said, ‘O people! Whoever knows a thing should say it, and whoever does not know should say, ‘Allah knows best.’ ”(31 It is part of At-Tabari 21 :242. At-Tabari 21 :242. 131 Al-Qutubi 15:230.

knowledge, when one does not know, to say “Allah knows best.” For Allah said to your Prophet sgg: oi ty It C 4Say “No wage do I ask ofyou for this, nor am I one of the Mutakallifin.”} This was reported by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.^ AU&« %= >> f* j,} 411 is only a Reminderfor all the creatures. means, the Qur’an is a reminder for all those who are held accountable, men and Jinn. This was the view of Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him. This Ayah is like the Ayat ithat I may therewith ivam you and ivhomsoever it may reach} (6:19), and 4but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place (11:17). 4’tQ ir&j} 4And you shall certainly blow the truth of it} means, “you will see confirmation that what he says is true.’ ij/K '^} }after a while.} means, soon. Qatadah said, “After death. Ikrimah said, “It means, on the Day of Resurrection.” There is no contradiction between the two views, because whoever dies comes under the rulings of the Day of Resurrection.

Surah 39: Az-Zumar

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The Tafsirof SuratAz-Zumar

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4940]

(Chapter - 39) Which was revealed in Makkah

The Virtues of SuratAz-Zumar

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4940–4955]

An-Nasal recorded that ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, “The Messenger of Allah used to fast until we would say, ‘He does not want to break fast,’ and he would not fast until we would say, He does not want to fast.’ And he jfe used to recite Bani Isra’il (A/-/srd’| and Az-Zumar every night. J-sS In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ‘S\ fl gbi cZjz*Y\ jgi\ U ‘vi ^2 u ^ bbJi&& Ji &T A yi ii £& V ii’ 6^ *_i (ii li j f&z ii’ 6J i£j i\ GjyLl c5U i?, 1^: j iit# j5 >z 4±&® At A 41. The revelation of this Book is from Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise.} ^2. Verily, We have sent down the Book to you in truth. So, worship Allah by doing religious deeds sincerely for Him only.} 43. Surely, the religion is for Allah only. And tlwse who take protectors besides Him (say) : "We worship them only that they may bring us near to Allah." Verily, Allah will judge between than concerning that wherein they differ. Truly fAllah guides not him who is a liar, and a disbeliever.} 44. Had Allah willed to take a son, He could have chosen [il Ahmad no. 25664, An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :444.

357 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (1 - 4) (Part-23) i Surely, the religion is for Allah only.) meaning, He will not accept any deed unless it is done purely and sincerely for Him Alone, with no partner or associate. Then Allah tells us that the idolaters say: v> t) 4 We worship them only that they may bring us near to Allah.) meaning what motivates them to worship them is the fact that they made their idols in the image of the angels - or so they claim - and when they worship those images it is like worshipping the angels, so that they will intercede with Allah for them to help and give them provision and other worldly needs. As far as the resurrection is concerned, they denied it and did not believe in it. Qatadah, As-Suddi and Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam and Ibn Zayd: 4&& Ji ionly that they may bring us near to Allah.) means, “So that they may intercede for us and bring us closer to Him.”¹¹¹ During Jahiliyyah, they used to recite the following for their Talbiyah when they performed Hajj; “At Your service, You have no partner except the partner You have; he and all that he owns belong to You.” This pretentious argument which the idolaters of all times, ancient and modern, used as evidence is what the Messengers, may the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them all, came to refute and forbid, and to call people to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. This is something that the idolaters themselves invented; Allah did not give them permission for it, nor does He approve of it; indeed, He hates it and forbids it.

ill IjAicI J '3_yC> iil 4 CJ1> Jjjj) 4And verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah, and avoid Taghiit.") (16:36) *0 VI\ V % 4\ Vi J I^ I *4 4And We did not send any Messenger before you but We m At-Tabari 21:251, 252.

'mssm .as the stubborn Jews •T|"; - Y'. 'x' and Christians claim IT' toyr and Isa to bo. Allah, may He be “^ed and exalted> 0 q; i_iV J iif \$ c jLz £? u>b-tr' ^j(^ }Had Allah willed to (h take a son (°r offspring), ysf, si " tte cohW /ifloe chosen ^ whom He willed out of 'o led who,n He -*?. ^s i- "i 'V' «•-"" c ' "“x *\\ meaning, the matter >< ' .xi'Sks x' At T'i' * '->' '*\\ nr would not have been - * J ^ **&-* as they claim. This is ji \ a conditional sentence , <> ^ „> i - which does not imply that this happened or that h is permitted; . 'tssf _ ^ ' indeed, it is Cp impossible. The aim is only to point out the ignorance of their claims. It is like the Ayat. 4'w't^uij tk=> uj. ji ijiV (jl jui Ji "Sy jj> 4Had We intended to take a pastime, We could surely have taken itfrom Us, ifWe were going to do (that).} (21:17) i%U*X %\\ fcf%&&X oj js» iSay: "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of worshippers."} (43:8 1) All of these Ayat are conditional, and it is permissible to form a conditional sentence referring to something that is It is necessary to see the explanation of this Ayah to understand its meaning.

impossible if it serves the purposes of the speaker. 'M\$h^} 4But glory be to Him! He is Allah, the One, the Irresistible.} means, exalted and sanctified be He above the idea that He could have any offspring, for He is the One, the Only, the Unique, the Self-Sufficient Master to Whom everything is enslaved and is in need of. He is the One Who is independent of all else, Who has subjugated all things and they submit humbly to Him. Blessed and exalted be He far above what the wrongdoers and deniers say. jQA J* Jjpi 3!^ sics % Vi 23i V&X il j^^ 1 'If X- i .o^/%a> iyl» <5. He has created the heavens and the earth with truth. He makes the night to go in the day and makes the day to go in the night. And He has subjected the sun and tire moon. Each runningfor an appointed term. Verily, He is the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving .} 46 . He created you (all) from a single person ; then made from him his wife. And He has sent down for you of An'dm eight pairs. He creates you in the wombs of your mothers, creation after creation in three veils of darktress. Such is Allah your Lord. His is the kingdom. Ld ildha ilia Huwa. Hoiv then are you turned away?} Evidence ofthe Power and Oneness ofAllah Allah tells us that He is the Creator of what is in the heavens and on earth, and what is between them. He is the Sovereign and Controller alternating the night and day. 4^'’—A JJ' jffdf 4He makes the night to go in the day and makes the day to go in the night.}

means, He has subjugated them and He causes them to alternate without ceasing, each seeking the other rapidly, as He says: J3Sgs 4He brings the night -as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly> (7:54). This is the meaning of that which was narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Qatadah, As- Suddi and others. 4^ fit&y *35 4And He has subjected the sun and the moon. Each running for an appointed term.} means, for a period of time that is known to Allah, then it will come to an end on the Day of Resurrection. <53S'9sir;i*> iVerily, He is the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving.} means, beside His might, greatness and pride, He is Oft- Forgiving to those who disobey Him but then turn to Him in repentance. 4He created you (all)from a single person;}, means, He created you, with all your varied races, types, languages and colors, from a single soul, who was Adam, peace be upon him. 4^~jH} 3** ft 4then madefrom him his wife.} who was Hawwa’, peace be upon her. This is like the

Ayah: U& Cyl* Iffjj jw sjfr ih 'j*3' 40 mankind! Have Tacpva ofyour Lord, Who created you from a single person, and from him He created his wife, and from 111 Al-Qurtubi 15:235.

them both He created many men and women (4:1). '4-r-5 o' 4>1>^ } And He has sent down for you of cattle eight pairs.} means, He has created for you from among the cattles,' eight pairs. These are the ones that are mentioned in Surat Al- An'am, eight kinds - a pair of sheep, a pair of goats, a pair of camels and a pair of oxen. } He creates you in the wombs ofyour mothers,} means, He forms you in your mothers' wombs. a* j ^creation after creation}. Everyone of you is originally a Nutfah, then he becomes an 'Alaqah, then he becomes a Mudghah} then he is created and becomes flesh and bones and nerves and veins, and the Ruti (soul) is breathed into him, and he becomes another type ofcreation. £3 ill&&} iSo Blessed is Allah, the Best ofcreators} (23:14). tin three veils of darkness} means, in the darkness of the womb, the darkness of the placenta which blankets and protects the child, and the darkness of the belly. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd.'3' iSuch is Allah your Lord.} means, the One Who created the ''' Although the word An'am is usually translated as cattle the meaning is broader and includes all kinds of similar grazing livestock such as sheep, goats and camels. See volume three, the Tafsir of SuratAl-An'am (6 : 142] [2 | For an understanding of these terms, see volume seven, the Tafsir of SuratAl-Mu'minun [23 : 12-14] '3 At-Tabari 2 1 :258 , 259 . Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 : 236

heavens and the earth and everything in between, and created you and your forefathers, is the Lord. To Him belong sovereignty and control over all of that. 4La ildha ilia Huwa.} means, no one else should be worshipped except Him alone with no partner or associate. 4How then are you turned away?} means, how can you worship anything besides Him? What has happened to your minds? jf "jj -fs 3&1 aKf! Is? ^4 o{ } o'jj !iJc fC\ IL 4) f jjj bj]j o? U 4 Y '*> s* c£>i} J-* 'j\j ijp-yiil' ot iiC) ji o* 3**y Jr* oi !> 47. // you disbelieve, then verily, Allah is not in need ofyou; He likes not disbelieffor His servants. And ifyou are grateful, He is pleased therewith for you . No bearer ofburdens shall bear the burden of another. Then to your Lord is your return, and He will inform you what you used to do. Verily, He is the All-Knower of that which is in breasts.} 48. And when some hurt touches man, he cries to his Lord, turning to Him in repentance. But when He bestows a favor upon him from Himself, he forgets that for which he cried for before, and he sets up rivals to Allah, in order to mislead others from His path. Say: "Take pleasure in your disbelief for a while, surely, you are (one) of the dwellers of the Fire!"} Allah hates Disbeliefand is pleased with Gratitude Allah tells us that He is Independent and has no need of anything in creation. This is like the Ayah in which Musa, peace be upon him, says: 4 U £S atd4££>0 4& jU ES& 4} 4"If you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich, Owner ofall praise."} (14:8).

In Sahih Muslim, it says: ^ j^TJ i^~b oi jl >i «ULi iUi ^yiai I* ijL^f ""O My servants, if the first and the last ofyou, men and Jinn alike, were all to be as evil as the most evil man among you, that would not diminishfrom My sovereignty in the least,"d 1 * 1 «y& iHe likes not disbelieffor His servants.} means. He does not like it and He does not enjoin it. *3 ofr iAnd ifyou are grateful, He is pleased therewith for you.} means: He likes this for you and He will increase His favor upon you. }No bearer ofburdens shall bear the burden ofanother.} means, no person can bear anything for another; each person will be asked

about his own affairs. Us lb pSCLuj fif, ji y} iThen to your Lord is your return, and He will inform you what you used to do. Verily, He is the All-Knower of that which is in breasts.} means, nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. It is an aspect of Man's Disbelief that He remembers Allah at times of difficulty then associates others with Him after He has been relieved of His Distress ii\$ i _/> J—sfi jS \>\f} iAnd wheti some hurt touches man, he cries to his Lord, turning to Him in repentance.} means, at times of need, he prays to Allah and seeks His help m Muslim 4 :1994.

alone, not associating anything with Him. This is like the Ayah: ^ o^j J' j Ji! (X—* *jjj^ ^And when harm touches you upon the sea /hose that you call upon vanish from you except Him. But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away. And man is ever ungrateful.} (17:67). Allah says: jf o? I* ili / *Jy~ b) f} iBut when He bestows a favor upon him from Himself, he forgets thatfor which he criedfor before,} means, at the time of ease, he forgets that supplication and prayer. This is like the Ayah d\s==» u lib j! 'jtb jt bWj 4And when harttt touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as ifhe had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him!} (10:12). o* j-i jUJ iand he sets up rivals to Allah, in order to mislead others from His path.} means, at times of ease, he associates others in worship with Allah and sets up rivals to Him. ijii <T£tA -j. Jc) yji jJ£ js£ }Say : “Take pleasure in your disbelieffor a while, surely, you are (one) of the dwellers of the Fire!”} means, say to those whose way this is, ‘enjoy your disbelief for a while!’ This is a stem threat and solemn warning, as in the Ayat

l Tafstr Ibn Kathir iSay: "Enjoy! But certainly, your destination is the Fire!") (14:30). iWe let them enjoy far a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment.) (31:24) j4 j* 'fj-> *-j^ Lr»\$* J&-. t*Ajj 'I5C j l2l jjii" "j <j£j jJZ ykt <9. Is one who is obedient to Allah, Ana'a Al-Layl prostrating and standing fearing the Hereafter and hoping far the mercy of his Lord? Say : "Are those who know equal to those who know not?" It is only men ofunderstanding who will remember.) The Obedient and the Sinner are not equal Allah says, “is the one who is like this equal to one who associates others in worship with Allah and sets up rivals to Him?’ They are not equal before Allah, as He says: i&Zj&z \$& S\ *41: til^60\$£ \$£ \£j) iNot all ofthem are alike; a party of the People of the Scripture standfar the right, they recite the Ayat ofAllah And'a Al-Layl, prostrating themselves (in prayer.) (3:113). And Allah says here: i&J>j lix\$ iVSU ils one who is obedient to Allah, Ana'a Al-Layl prostrating and standing) meaning, one who is humble and fears Allah when he prostrates and stands (in prayer). It was reported that Ibn Mas“ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “The obedient one is one who obeys Allah and His Messenger jg.”111 Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said, Ana’a Al-Layl means in the depths of the night.121 111 Al-Qurtubi 15:239. Al-Qurtubi 15:239.

as£5^ ^fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy ofhis Lord.} means, in his worship he feels both fear and hope. Both are essential in worship, and fear should be stronger during one's lifetime. Allah says: \fijj ^fearing the Hereafter and hoping far the mercy ofhis Lord.} At the time of death, hope is uppermost, as Imam ‘Abd bin Humayd recorded in his Musnad from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, who said, “The Messenger of Allah jg entered upon a man who was dying, and said to him, Its «How do you feel?* He said, 1 am both afraid and hopeful.’ The Messenger ofAllah jg said: fe > '4,i :&i Ni ui ji j jIp . li j iy?y. tTItese do not co-exist in a person's heart at times such as this, but Allah

will give him what he hopes for and protect him from that which he fears .n”* 11 This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal in Al-Yawm wal- Laylah, and Ibn Majah from the Hadith of Yasar bin Hatim from Ja'far bin Sulayman. At-Tirmidhi said, “Gharib.”,21 Imam Ahmad recorded that Tamim Ad-Dari, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: «Whoever recites one hundred Ayat in one night, it will be recorded as if he prayed all night. This was also recorded by An-Nasal in Al-Yawm wal- LaylahP I 1 ‘Abd bin Humayd ; 404. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :57, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:262, Ibn Majah 131 Ahmad 4 :103

mm iv ^ 't? t*~ Mr v ->v ->,c.< , > . ^ ' .,{. ? . -> .<>.1 . > <JOI!) oJAU oyll Sji J " '* Sf 4Sat/: "Are those who know equal to those who know not?"} means, is this one equal with the one who sets up rivals to Allah to mislead (men) from His path? MVi ijil f£ ilt is only men of understanding who will remember.} means, the only one who will understand the difference between them is the one who has understanding. And Allah knows best. \pd UM £& ji> 4 S'jJJ pfj ta: -aigj » ' -S -7— lif O-el J Cij»I 41 ji '*;!;yl^j- Ojyggji Jy Q>\ *si\ ,jflj iZ.'ZZ Ciili '& dP& Ijj 4 410. Say: "O My servants who believe, have Taqwa of your Lord. Good is for those who do good in this world, and Allah's earth is spacious! Only those who are patient shall receive their reward in full, without reckoning."} 111. Say: "Verily, I am commanded to worship Allah, making religion sincerelyfor Him."} 112. "And I am commanded (this) in order that I may be the first of the Muslims."}

The Command for Taqwa, Emigration and to worship Him alone with all Sincerity Allah commands His believing servants to remain steadfast in their obedience and have Taqwa of Him. Clif ;xl 4 'cdi p;j \pr. iSay: "O My servants who believe, have Taqwa ofyour Lord. Good is far those who do good in this world..."} means, the one who does good deeds in this world, will have a good (reward) in this world and in the Hereafter. iand Allah's earth is spacious!) Mujahid said, “So emigrate through it and strive hard and keep away from idols.” djJGili 4 (o\)Only those who are patient shall receive their reward in full, without reckoning.) Al-'Awza'i said, “Their reward will not be weighed or measured; they will be given an immense reward.” As-Suddi said: iOnly those wlv are patient shall receive their reward in full, witfwut reckoning.) means, “In Paradise.”*2 il iG* iif xil it 0^1 iSay: "Verily, I am commanded to worship Allah, making religion sincerelyfar Him..."} means, ‘I am commanded to worship Allah alone in all sincerity, with no partner or associate.’ # op& iAnd I am commanded (this) in order that I may be the first of the Muslims.) 111 At-Jabari 21 :269. ' At-Tabari 21 :270.

il3. Say: “Verily, if I disobey my Lord, I am afraid of the torment ofa great Day."} 414. Say: "Allah Alone I worship by doing religious deeds sincerelyfor His sake only."4 415. “So, worship what you like besides Him." Say: "The losers are those who will lose thetnselves and their families on

the Day of Resurrection. Verily, that will be a manifest loss!"}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4955–4971]

416. They shall have coverings of Fire, above them and covering (of Fire) beneath them . With this Allah frightens His servants: “O My servants, therefore have Tacpva ofMe!"} Creating Fear ofthe Punishment ofAllah Allah ‘says, say O Muhammad, even though you are the Messenger of Allah:’ fk i'- ie J>£] 4Verily, if I disobey my Lord, I am afraid of the torment of a great Day.} meaning the Day of

Resurrection. This is a conditional sentence, and if what is referred to here applies to the Prophet 3g, it applies even more so to others, 4Say: "Allah Alone I worship by doing religious deeds sincerely for His sake only. So, worship what you like besides Him."} This is also a threat, and a disowning of them. iUrftt Si 4Say: "The losers..."} means, the greatest losers of all,

371Surah 39. Az-Zumar (13 - 16) (Part-23) iare those who will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection .} means, they will be separated and will never meet again, whether their families have gone to Paradise and they have gone to Hell, or all of them have gone to Hell, they will never meet or feel happiness again. iVerily, that will be a manifest loss!} means, this is the clearest and most obvious loss. Then He describes their state in the Fire: 'J. jltf^0 JI ft} iThey shall have coverings of Fire, above them and covering (of Fire) beneath them.} This is like the Ayat 4 j» bfi 'f+*r OJ iTheirs will be a bed of Hell (Fire), and over them coverings (of Hell-fire). Thus do We recompense the wrongdoers} (7:41) C IAj* 4^ ite Ji 4»b^' («< « *•« iOn the Day when the torment (Hell-fire) shall cover them from above them and from underneath their feet, and it will be said: "Taste what you used to do."} (29:55) ^ -Jj Hit •^i} iWith this Allah frightens His servants:} means, Allah tells us about this, which will undoubtedly come to pass, to frighten His servants, so that they will keep away from unlawful things and from sin. iO My servants, therefore have Taqwa of Me!} . means, Fear My wrath, My anger, My punishment and My vengeance.' liUljl} Hit ^4'j1L> ojJjt »iL^!jl iHl—

417. Those who avoid At-Tdghiit by not worshipping them and turn to Allah, for them are glad tidings; so announce the good news to My servants. 418. Those who listen to the Word and follow the best thereof, those are (the ones) whom Allah has guided and those are men of understanding.} Good News for the Righteous 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, narrating from his father: Jufj} 4Those who avoid At-Tdghiit by not worshipping them} was revealed concerning Zayd bin 'Amr bin Nufayl and Abu Dharr and Salman Al-Farisi, may Allah be pleased with them. 111 The correct view is that it includes them and all others who avoided worshipping idols and turned to the worship of Ar-Rahman. These are the people for whom there is good news in this world and in the Hereafter. Then Allah says: Jy, Ojji jCt, 'Jif} iso announce the good news to My servants - those who listen to the Word and follow the best thereof,} meaning, those who understand it and act in accordance with it. This is like the Words of Allah, may He be exalted, to Musa, peace be upon him, when He gave him the Tawrah: 4 liUji }yu 4Hold unto these with firmness, and enjoin your people to take the better therein} (7 :145). 4*^ lAlf} ithose are whom Allah has guided} means, those who are described in this manner are the ones whom Allah has guided in this world and the Hereafter. Ill At-Tabari 2 1 :274

iand those are men of understanding.} means, they possess sound reasoning and an upright nature. o/ pi ^ iii oil? yijuf iX aS 'jJ\} 4if ,jIjLJ' ii' v—iht y Alii Jij iji ,j* V^C iX* 1-j oj 429. Is, then one against whom the Word of punishment is justified (equal to the one who avoids evil)? Will you resate him who is in the Fire?} 420. But those who have Taqivd of their Lord, for them are built lofty rooms, one above another under which rivers flow. (This is) the promise of Allah, and Allah does not fail in (His) promise.} Allah says, 'if He has decreed that someone is to be doomed, can you save him from his misguidance and doom?' Which means, no one can guide him apart from Allah, because whomever Allah leaves astray cannot be guided, and whomever He guides cannot be led astray. Then Allah tells us that His blessed servants will have lofty rooms in Paradise. 4ix: &} iare built lofty rooms, one above

another}, story upon story, solidly-constructed, adorned and high. ‘Abdullah bin Al-Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said: Is ‘ Is j op «/« Paradise there are rooms whose inside can be seen from the outside, and the outside can be seen from the inside.» A bedouin asked, Who are they for, O Messenger of Allah?’ He jg said, “For those who speak kindly, feed the hungry and stand in prayer at night whilst the people are sleeping .d”* 11 This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Hasan Gharib”P\ Imam Ahmad recorded from Sahl bin Sa’d, may m Ahmad 1 : 155. ,2i Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :23 1

374 Tajstr Ibn Kathir Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah said: i.UUl jilJUS\$ l bji\y US t^Jl^ Z'jj\ Jii b\» «77ie peop/e 0/ Paradise will look towards each other in raised places of Paradise as you look towards the stars on the horizons of the skyj He said, “I told An-Nu*man bin Abi ‘Ayyash about that, and he said, 1 heard Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, narrate it: «£pSil j) JiVIJ giiJl l bjiV) US« «As you see the stars on the horizon of the east or the westy ”[11 Itwas also recorded in theTwo Sahibs.'2 Imam Ahmad said, “Fazarah narrated to us; Fulayh narrated to us; from Hilal bin ‘Ali, from ‘Ata’ bin Yasar, from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah ggg said: by*i> us jif j byyjd !>i> tThe people of Paradise will look towards each other in the raised places of Paradise as you look at the high, bright stars which remain on the horizon. Such will be the difference in superiority which some ofthem have over others .» They said, “O Messenger of Allah, are those the abodes of the Prophets?” He sgl said: *No, by the One in Whose Hand is my soul, they are the abodes of people who believed in Allah and in the Messengersy3^ It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, who said, “Hasan Sahih.”141 111 Ahmad 5:340. [2) Fath Al-Bdri 1 1 : 424 , Muslim 4 :2 177 131 Alunad 2:339. 141 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :272

375 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (21 - 22) (Part-23) c&m rn C - S' - >. J, •/ "i ""11 '(j)\£ Sy«& f&k dr*Jil^Si (iU'j til 1 jL&q^ui) li f i^ ** ^ i j^,4 < *O*' rf"» .<"> O^muSvj biJl 4.^CSi(^j.ijjis;^a\$3^ #^#2*4®Si^jjStSyW^ />^v » ""*» y» m S S' ?•*** A/J1 i <* /^J)U Otfff c^a « og^> iunder which rivers flow.^ means, the rivers flow wherever the people want them to flow. *i' 'SO{ i(This is) the promise of Allah,} means, ‘all that We have mentioned here is

what Allah has promised to His believing servants.’ i:\eZJ? 6xit “i 'ti djff iand Allah does not fail in (His) promise.} «!Oif ot 'ij' iy J 'y jj^ >j qfji\ i gjZ is3jli it. p 'S0 & * & «Sf cr <& 4?i 4 k bet &*. m z& yj. 4 ki^j' Jfi Jt 4 T-f A Sj> ‘ff) a* jj AJ-ii 421 . See you not that Allah sends down water from the sky, and causes it to penetrate the earth, as water springs, and afternvard thereby produces crops of different colors, and afterward they wither and you see them turn yellow; then He makes them dry and broken pieces. Verily, in this is a reminder for men of understanding.} 422. Is he wlvse breast Allah has opened to Islam, so that he is in light from his Lord? So, woe to those whose hearts are hardened against remembrance of Allah! They are in plain

376 Tafslr Ibn Kathir error!} The Parable ofthe Life ofthis World Allah tells us that water originates in the sky. This is like the Ayah &£3«G%} iand We send down pure waterfrom the sky} (25:48). So, Allah sends down water from the sky, and it settles in the earth, then He causes it to flow wherever He wills, and He causes springs, great and small, to flow as needed. Allah says: jfjVf ^4 yz ,*£&} iand causes it to penetrate the earth, as water springs,} Said bin Jubayr and ‘Amir Ash-ShaTbi said that all the water on earth has its origins in the sky. * Said bin Jubayr said, its origins lie in the snow, meaning that snow

piles up in the mountains, then settles at the bottom (of the mountains) and springs flow from the bottom of them. and afterward thereby produces crops of different colors} means, then from the water which comes down from the sky or flows from springs in the earth, He brings forth crops of different colors, i.e., different kinds of forms, tastes, scents, benefits, etc. and afterward they wither} means, after they have been ripe and fresh, they become old and you see them turn yellow when they have dried out. and then He makes them dry and broken pieces.} means, then they become brittle. 4-4'Vi jji0\$ 4 1\} 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7:219.

4Verily, in this is a reminder for men of understanding .} means, those who are reminded by this and who learn the lesson from it, that this world is like this - it is green and fresh and beautiful, then it will become old and ugly. The young man will become a weak, senile old man, and after all of that comes death. The blessed one is the one whose state after death will be good. Allah often likens the life of this world to the way He sends down water from the sky and crops and fruits grow thereby, then they become dry and brittle. This is like the Ayah: Op*® iAtid put forward to them the example of the life of this world: it is like the water (rain) which We send down from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter. And Allah is able to do everything> (18:45) The People of Truth and the People of Misguidance are not Equal JrA3 »#» ils he whose breast Allah has opened to Islam, so that he is in light from his Lord?} means, is this person equal to the one who is hard-hearted and far from the truth? This is like the Ayah: 3-^3 aA 33 Ji -4-i I£_!* J jty ibizAA ils he who was dead and We gave him life and set for him a light (i.e. Belief) whereby he can walk amongst men - like him who is in the darkness (i.e., disbelief) from which he can never come out?} (6:122) Allah says: 45® 3i> J, iJM S3}

4So, woe to those whose hearts are hardened against remembrance of Allah!} meaning, they do not become soft when Allah is mentioned, and they do not feel humility or fear, and they do not understand. iaJ 4 iThey are in plain error!}. o; 'A L» 423 . Allah has sent down the Best Statement, a Book, its parts resembling each other, (and) oft-repeated. The skins of those who fear their Lord shiver from it. Then their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance of Allah. That is the guidance of Allah. He guides therewith whom He wills; and whomever Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide.} The Description of the Qur'an Here Allah praises His Book, the Noble Qur'an, which was revealed to His noble Messenger jfe. Allah says, 4'oB^ cr ±.fis jj; %\} iAllah has sent down the Best Statement, a Book, its parts resembling each other (and) oft-repeated.} Mujahid said, "This means that the entire Qur'an's parts resemble each other and are oft-repeated."* 11 Qatadah said, "One Ayah resembles another and one letter resembles another."*2 * Ad-Dahhak said, "It is oft-repeated so that people will understand what their Lord tells them." 'Ikrimah and Al- Hasan said, "There may be an Ayah in one Surah, and another Ayah in another Surah that resembles it." Said bin Jubayr narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him: "Oft-repeated means that parts of the Qur'an resemble m At-Tabari 2 1 :279 At-Tabari 21:279.

one another and repeat one another." Some of the scholars said that it was narrated from Sufyan bin TJaynah that its parts resembling each other (and) oft-repeated.} means that some passages of the Qur'an may sometimes refer to one thing, so they resemble one another, and sometimes they mention a thing and its opposite. Such as when the believers then the disbelievers are mentioned, or when

Paradise then Hell are described, and so on, and this is the meaning of oft-repeated. Examples include the Ayat iVerily, the most righteous will be in delight; and verily, the most wicked will be in the blazing Fire (Hell).} (82:13-14) J)£& C& Si iNay! Truly, the Record of the most wicked is (preserved) in \$ijjin} until iNay! Verily, the Record of the most righteous is (preserved) in Tlliyyim}131 (83: 7-18) S-
 *** O&Q 0\j “fl iThis is a Reminder. And verily, for those who have Taqwa is a goodfinal return (Paradise)} until; j3 ££&& iThis is so! Andfor those who transgress, there will be an evil final return (Fire).} (38:49-55). And there are other similar passages. All of this has to do with it being oft-repeated, i.e., when two meanings are referred to. But when a passage is about one thing, with some parts of it resembling others, this is “its parts resembling each other.” At-Tabari 21 :279. * See the following note
 * See the explanation of SuratAl-Mutajfifin (83 :7-18]

This is not the same as the Mutashabihat mentioned in the Ayah: >ti S# 4/h if are Ai/af that are entirely clear, they are the foundations of the Book; and others not entirely clear} (3:7). that refers to something else altogether. Si4j##^^ ^ 477ie s/cms 0/ those who fear their Lord shiver from it. Then their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance ofAllah.} means, this is the description of the righteous, when they hear the Words of the Compeller, the Protector, the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving, because they understand the promises and warnings contained therein. The frightening words and threats make their skin shiver from fear. Si f} iThen their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance of Allah.} because of their hope for His mercy and kindness. They are unlike others, the wicked, immoral sinners, in a number of ways: First They listen to the recitation of the Ayat [of the Qur’an], while those (sinners) listen to poetic verse recited by female singers. Second When the Ayat of Ar-Rahman are recited to them, they fall down in prostration weeping, with the proper attitude of fear, hope, love, understanding and knowledge, as Allah says: SLjj j cJUj 'ill i;) IZjj VJ4-2J' +4f> >•#-> *» iThe believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Ayat are recited unto them, they increase theirfaith; and they put their trust in their

381Surah 39. Az-Zumar (23) (Part-23) Lord; Who perform the Salah and spend out of that We have provided them. It is they who are the believers in it. For them are grades of dignity with their Lord, and forgiveness and a generous provision (i.e., Paradise).} (8 :2-4), U—o Ljiic iAnd those who, when they are reminded of the Ayat of their Lord, fall not on them (as if they were) deaf and blind} (25 :73). When they hear the Ayat of Allah, they Eire not too busy to pay attention to them; they listen to them Eind understand their meanings. So they act upon them and prostrate when they hear them, out of understEmding, not out of ignorance and blind following of others. Third They adhere to the correct etiquette when they listen to them. As the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, used to do when they listened to the words of Allah recited by the Messenger of Allah Their skin Would shiver, and their hearts would soften to the remembrance of Allah. They did not shout or do other actions that are not natural; on the contrary, they would sit quietly with the proper attitude of fear, in an unparalleled fashion, they attEiined the victory of praise from their Lord in this world and the Hereafter. ‘Abdur-Razzaq sEiid, “Ma’mar told us that Qatadsih, may Allah have mercy on him, recited, iThe skins of those who fear their Lord shiver from it. Then their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance ofAllah.} and said. This is the characteristic of the friends of Allah; Allah has described them in this mEinner, saying that their skin shivers, their eyes weep and their hearts find rest to the remembrEince of Allah.

He did not say that they lose their minds Emd swoon; that is the characteristic of the followers of innovation, and that comes from the Shaytan.” Allah’s saying:

382 Tafslr Ibtī Kathīr (That is the guidance of Allah. He guides therewith whom He wills;) means, this is the characteristic of those whom Allah has guided, and anyone who does anything different is one of those whom Allah has sent astray. Crt f ilif fj) iatid whomever Allah sends astray, far him there is no guide. 4 fa, offai ' / fafa ft fafajl+U ot 4-1' fa& ifa/fafa ifa j }fa\$ fafa, {iSf sgU 424. 7s he then, who will confront with his face the awful tontient on the Day of Resurrection? And it will be said to the wrongdoers : “Taste what you used to earn!”) 425. Those before them denied, and so the torment came on them from directions they perceived not.) 426. So, Allah made them to taste the disgrace in the present life, but greater is the torment of the Hereafter if they only blew!) The Final Destination of the Disbelievers P*- yUilf ifa ‘4-fag ifa. <>*r 4/s he then, who will confront with his face the awful torment on the Day of Resurrection?) he will be rebuked and he and the evildoers like him will be told: "jfa U 4Taste what you used to earn!) ‘Is this like the one who comes secure on the Day of Resurrection?’ as Allah says: 4/s Ik who walks prone on his face, more rightly guided, or he who walks upright on the straight way?) (67:22);

4^,^ o-* !A 4 4A**-4 Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire (it will be said to them): “Taste you the touch of Hell!”} (54:48), and 4/s he who is cast into the Fire better or he who comes secure on the Day of Resurrection?) (41:40) In each of these Ayat, it was sufficient to refer to one of the two groups. 4 ^ oi 4>U4ll (*+U ot } iThose before them denied, and so the torment came on them from directions they perceived not.} means, the previous generations who denied the Messengers were destroyed by Allah for their sins. And none had they to protect them from Allah. ijd1 4 4jii ill 4So Allah made them to taste the disgrace in the present life,} means, by means of the punishment and revenge which He sent down upon them, and the rejoicing of the believers for what happened to them. So, let those who are addressed beware, for they have rejected the noblest of the Messengers and the Seal of the Prophets And what Allah has promised them of severe punishment in the Hereafter is worse than whatever befell them in this world. Allah says: 'iojazW j *21 ' O tj <-5-J JA ot < Oi 4 1^4 Ji sp&z fgi ^ pi ((»rlj ol- 4^1 ^ J; 4 JuXl 4 427 . And indeed We have put forth for men, in this Qur'an every kind of parable in order that they may remember.}

428. An Arabic Qur'an, without any crookedness (therein) in order that they may have Taqwd of Him. 429. Allah puts forth a parable: a man belonging to many partners disputing with one another, and a man belonging entirely to one master. Are those two equal in comparison? All the praises and thanks be to Allah! But most of them know not. 430. Verily, you zoill die, and verily, they (too) will die. 431. Then, on the Day of Resurrection, you will be disputing before your Lord.} The Parable of Shirk 4f£y v, j o^i Off* j 4And indeed We have put forth for men, in this Qur'an every kind of parable means, We have explained things to mankind in it [the Qur'an] by setting forth examples and parables.' 4in order that they may remember.} Because parables bring the meaning closer to people's minds. As Allah says: ft fin*} 4He sets forth for you a parable from yourselves (30:28). meaning, 'so that you may learn it from yourselves.' And Allah says: uj tyh vQZ jiVi 4in Order that they may have Taqwa of Him.} (29:43). 4g>e «^> j* Of*- 4An Arabic Qur'an, without any crookedness (therein)) means, it is in a

plain Arabic tongue, with no crookedness, deviation or confusion. It is plain, clear proof. Allah has made it like this and has revealed it like this, &}

385 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (27 - 31) (Part-23) in order that they may have Taqwd of Him} means, in order that they may heed the warnings contained therein, and strive to attain the promises therein. Then Allah says: Hi* *~rCr iAllah puts forth a parable : a matt belonging to many partners disputing with one another,} meaning, they were disputing concerning that slave in whom they all had a share. 4.^), '&»} iatid a (slave) man belonging entirely to one master.} means, no one owned him except that one man. &} iAre those two equal in comparison?} meaning, they are not the same. By the same token, the idolater who worships other gods besides Allah and the sincere believer who worships none besides Allah, with no partner or associate, are not equal. What comparison can there be between them? Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid and others said, “This Ayah is the parable of the idolater and the sincere believer.” Because this parable is so clear and obvious, Allah then says: il Xl\} iAll the praises and thanks be to Allah!} i.e., for establishing proof against them. *f&u& iBut most of them know not.} means, and for this reason they associate others in worship with Allah. The fact that the Messenger of Allah^and Quraysh will die, and how They will dispute before Allah Allah’s saying; fn At-Tabari 2 1 :285

386 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr ^ pj-lj cZ* <J&[} iVerily, you will die, and verily, they (too) will die.} This is one of the Ayat which Abu Bakr As-Siddlq, may Allah be pleased with him, quoted when the Messenger of Allah jg died, so that the people would realize that he had really died. Another Ayah which he quoted was: ;U»I jl oli jjUl ^ - iSj A., -i c-^ iMuhammad is no more than a Messenger, and indeed (many) Messengers have passed away before him . If he dies or is killed, iwill you then turn back on your heels? And he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will do to Allah; and Allah will give reward to those who are grateful>(3:144).

The meaning of this Ayah is that you will certainly depart this

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4971–4972]

world and be gathered before Allah in the Hereafter. You will dispute the issues of Tawhid and Shirk before Allah, things over which you disputed in this world, and He will judge between you with truth, and He is the Judge, the All-Knowing. So, He will save the sincere believers who worship Him alone, and He will punish the disbelievers who deny His Oneness and associate others in worship with Him. Although this Ayah speaks about the believers and disbelievers, and how they will dispute in the Hereafter, it also includes all disputants in this world, for their disputes will come back to them in the Hereafter. Ibn Abi Hatim, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Ibn Az-Zubayr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When the Ayah iThen, on the Day of Resurrection, you will be disputing before your Lord.} was revealed, Az-Zubayr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, will we repeat our disputes?’ He jg said. «Yes.» He (Az-Zubayr) said, This is a very serious

387 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (27 - 31) (Part-23) matter.”¹¹¹ Ahmad recorded from Az-Zubayr bin Al-‘Awwam, may Allah be pleased with him, that when this Surah was revealed to the Messenger of Allah sg: iVerily, you will die, and verily, they (too) will die. Then, on

the Day of Resurrection, you will be disputing before your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4972]

Lord.} Az-Zubayr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “O Messenger of Allah, will the sins that we committed against others in this world be repeated for us?” He 5S said, t , & js ji aYes, they will be repeated until everyone who is entitled will have his rights restored to him .» Az-Zubayr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “By Allah, it is a very serious matter.”¹²¹ It was also recorded by At- Tirmidhi, who said “Hasan Sahih.”¹³¹ ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: pf i* g pi& iThen, on the Day of Resurrection, you will be disputing before your Lord.} means, the truthful one will dispute with the liar, the oppressed will dispute with the oppressor, the one who is guided will dispute with the one who is misguided and the weak will dispute with the arrogant. Ibn Mandah recorded in Kitab Ar-Ruh that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The people will dispute on

the Day of Resurrection, to the extent that the soul will

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4972–5011]

dispute with the body. The soul will say to the body, ‘You did such and such,’ and the body will say to the soul, You told 111 Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 5 :614, Ahmad with similar wording along with the following version 121 Ahmad 1:164. 131 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :289

389 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (32 - 35) (Part-24) An-Nasal. <£y>* reir ij > jtlj 4i' Jp jJLkt <^y«L£j U fi JI 'AjLlj o-C*y »t». i^l} , ^y-3 (4=>?J ~fl -liA. h'J' *^)- liU'i -C£ 4fjifofoLjo cfj' j <32. 77ten, who does more wrong than one who utters a lie against Allah, and denies the truth when it comes to him! Is there not in Hell an abode for the disbelievers?} <33. And he who has brought the truth and (those who) believed therein, they are those ivho have Taqwa.} <34. They shall have all that they will desire with their Lord. That is the reward of the doers of good.} <35 . So that Allah may expiate from them the evil of what they did and give them the reward, according to the best of ivhat they used to do.} The Punishment of the Disbelievers and Liars, and the Reward of the Sincere Believers The idolaters uttered lies against Allah and said that there were other gods besides Him and claimed that the angels were the daughters of Allah and that Allah had a son - glorified be He far above all that they say. Moreover, they rejected the truth when it came to them on the lips of the Messengers (peace and blessings be upon them all). Allah says: -,3;L ji 4iii (Jp - pCit £} iThen, who does more wrong than one who utters a lie against Allah, and denies the truth when it comes to him!} meaning, there is no one who does more wrong than such a person, because he combines the two aspects of falsehood, disbelief in Allah and disbelief in the Messenger of Allah. They made false claims and rejected the truth, Allah threatened them: m An-Nasal in Al-Kubra no. 11447. This refers to the civil turmoil that began with the assassination of Uthman , may Allah be pleased with him

ils there not iti Hell an abodefor the disbelievers?} who are the deniers and rejecters. Then Allah says: 4*ft tiJLlJL ;UL ^ 4And he ia/io has brought the truth and (those who) believed therein,} Mujahid, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas and Ibn Zayd said, “The one who brought the truth was the Messenger ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: 4j-iJL »t». isfftj 4”And he who has brought the truth>

means the Messenger of Allah s&. 4*, 4and (those who) believed therein^ means the Muslims.”*2 4^* £ 4they are those who have Taqwa}. Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “They fear and shun Shirk, ”*3 4fj {jM 15 4They shall have all that they will desire with their Lord.} means, in Paradise; whatever they ask for they will have. (4^ (*rv^=> ill! !})». 4That is the reward of doers of good. So that Allah may expiate from ti\em the evil of what they did and give them the reward, according to the best of what they used to do.} This is like the Ayah: 44*4 4* y rc'v * iWSj (tet&pgZ At-Tabari 21 :289, Al-Qurtubi 15:256. At-Tabari 21 :290. 131 At-Tabari 21 :292.

tfif iThey are those from whom We shall accept the best of their deeds and overlook their evil deeds. (They shall be) among the dwellers of Paradise, a promise of truth, which they have been promised (46:16). lull ^jjljt jl Mill j/j ^ llyAXj U ji <i! ilXi v5-*— (3^~ lj c?r*- J» ci->y j* *JLr* u* J cil. | ^==&£» Ji , .•_J | £ ^ ^ 4» .j- x . ^ y Jj£j A_-ju ^ ,™.J^U_a> <36. /s not Allah Sufficient for His servant? Yet they try to frighten you with those besides Him! And whom Allah sends astray, for him there will be no guide.} 437. And whomsoever Allah guides, for him there will be no misleader. Is not Allah Almighty, Possessor of Retribution?} 438. And verily, if you ask them: “Wlw created the heavens and the earth?” Surely, they will say: “Allah.” Say: “Tell me then, the things that you invoke besides Allah - if Allah intended some harm for me, could they remove His harm? Or if He intended some mercy for me, could they withhold His mercy?” Say: “Sufficient for me is Allah; in Him those who trust must put their trust.”} 439. Say: “O My people! Work according to your way, I am working. Then you will come to know”} 440. “To whom comes a disgracing torment, and on whom descends an everlasting torment.”} Allah is Sufficient for His Servant Allah says: 4»J1* i3i! (j-jjfy 41s not Allah Sufficient for His servant?} Some of them read it “His servants.” It means that Allah is Sufficient for the one who

392 TafsTr IbtI Kathir worships Him and relies upon Him. oi iYet they try to frighten you with those besides Him!} means, the idolaters tried to scare the Messenger of Allah jfa with their idols and gods which they called upon besides Allah out of ignorance and misguidance. Allah says: iAnd whom Allah sends astray, for Imn there will be no guide. And whomsoever Allah guides, for him there will be no misleader. Is not Allah Almighty, Possessor of Retribution?} meaning, whoever relies on Him and turns to Him, will never be forsaken, for He is the Almighty Who cannot be overwhelmed by another, and there is none more severe than Him in exacting retribution on those who disbelieve in Him, associate others in worship with Him and resist His Messenger as- The Idolaters admit that Allah is the Sole Creator because Their gods are incapable iAnd verily, if you ask them : “Who created the heavens and the earth?” Surely, they will say: “Allah.”} means, the idolaters used to recognize that Allah was the Creator of all things, but despite that they still worshipped others besides Him, others who had no power to bring benefit or cause harm. Allah said: •t - ’ > y Kir* o* J* o/j ot i; /l * 's' .> ^ -'S iSay : “Tell me then, the things that you invoke besides Allah - if Allah intended some harm for me, could tiey remove His harm? Or ifHe (Allah) intended some mercyfor me, could they withlwld His mercy?”} meaning, they cannot do any of that at all. Here Ibn Abi

393 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (36 - 40) (Part-24) Hatim recorded a narration from Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, attributing it to the Prophet jg: *U^ ^ 4)1 Jyu ii1Le>L»u oJU>u lal>'l i 4)1 JxL>-IB ii^/1 jl jLjplj t<i)ti 01*^1 lilj i<))l jbu JjL. lil t 5,1.1.11 illJjJu p wOi' 4)1 if ij>^AiS/l >..a4../ill OjL>-

liljiiij jU iii] 4)1 hyuCj ji Si; 13^- #2 u 'J* pd\j V\ (Uiij .Orfji j ji) jiii; «Be mindful of Allah and He will protect you ; be mindful of Allah and you will find Him ever with you. Turn to Allah in times of ease and He will turn to you in times of difficulty. If you ask anyone for anything, then ask Allah; if you seek help from anyone, then seek help from Allah. Know that even if the entire nation were to come together to do you some harm that Allah has not decreed for you, they will never be able to harm you, and if they were to come together to do you some good that Allah has not decreed for you, they will never be able to do that. The pages have dried and the pens have been lifted. Strive for the sake of Allah with thankfulness and firm conviction, and know that in patiently persevering with regard to something that you dislike there is much goodness. Victory comes with patience, a way out comes from difficulty and with hardship comes ease." iSay: "Sufficient for me is Allah..."} means, 'Allah is enough for me.' 4 'iffi *&} iln Him I put my trust, and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him.) [12: 67] This is like what Hud, peace be upon him, said to his people: 111 Ahmad 1 :307.

nr mmm .•os"Y tsfill 'AxaJm [j ^ >£^sjiij ^ayJ Ojl^ i^r : j Ijij ([po^L:—Jp& ' j [^JLb ol^j^<^A^3si! y^*<-i }s. * * <'•< C >>-5 \ j^ii jty ill Jjil tJ~i l'~.-«l^ *4 ^ IJi^fj S>J^>2 -AJJ Oi ']'!*"UJj£iS 4l rj;i>4^ "i j5 \if o; £ 4i ^ J® oi I ;l^ll Jki-H y» VI iiVj J* jj 4"All that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil." He said: "I call Allah to witness and bear you witness that I am free from that which you as- cribe as partners in wor- ship, with Him. So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path."}(l 1:54-56). & !A^t i%h iSay: "OMy people! Work according to your way..."\$ This is a threat and a warning. 4/ am working^ means, 'according to my way.' cj iThen you will come to kttow\$ means, you will learn the consequences. V>'J

4To whom comes a disgracing torment means, in this world, iand on whom descends an everlasting torment. means, ongoing and eternal, with no escape, which will come on the Day of Resurrection. We seek refuge with Allah from that. J-iu (2lj j-S jij 1 U/1 ^ a4 di ^ 6jii? ^ 447 . Verily, We have sent down to you the Book for mankind in truth. So, whosoever accepts the guidance, it is only for himself; and whosoever goes astray, he goes astray only to his (own) loss. And you are not a trustee over them .} 442 . It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep. He keeps those (souls) for which He has ordained death and sends the rest for a term appointed. Verily, in this are signs for a people who think deeply.} Allah says, addressing His Messenger Muhammad 5%: iVerily, We have sent down to you the Book} meaning, the Qur'an. 4for mankind in truth.} means, for all of creation, mankind and Jinn, so that he may warn them therewith. 4So, whosoever accepts the guidance, it is only for himself;} means, the benefit of that will return to him. 34>. 3-i J*j} iand whosoever goes astray, he goes astray only for his (own) loss.} means, the consequences of that will return to him.

i<3&. V>) iAnd you are not a trustee over them .) means, "you are not responsible for guiding them.' j* iib you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Trustee over all things) (11:12). i&jf gif J& Ob) iyour duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning) (13:40). Allah is the One Who causes Death and gives Life Then Allah tells us that He is in control of all things and does as He wills. He causes men to die (the "greater death") when He sends the angels to take men's souls from their bodies, and He causes them to "die a lesser death" when they sleep. Allah says: — ' - I I > ' - - l — i 1 s s J r M \$ *\$ v# dij ±£\piK 4//

is He, lafto takes your souls by night (when you are asleep), and has knowledge of all that you have done by day, then He raises (wakes) you up again that a term appointed be fulfilled, then (in the end) unto Him will be your return. Then He will inform you of that which you used to do. He is the Irresistible, over His servants, and He sends guardians (angels guarding and writing all of one's good and bad deeds) over you, until when death approaches one of you, Our messengers (angels) take his soul, and they never neglect their duty.)(6:60-61). Here Allah mentions the two deaths, the lesser death then the greater death after it; in the Ayah above (39: 42), He mentions the greater then the lesser. Allah says: cfe* 4 ddCt j) J)[iru- jJbVf Xf. «^)

It is Allah Who takes away the souls at the time of their death, and those that die not during their sleep. He keeps those (souls) for which He has ordained death and sends the rest for a term appointed. This indicates that they [the souls] meet in the higher realm, as was stated in the Hadith attributed to the Prophet which was narrated by Ibn Mandah and others. In the Two Sahihs of Al-Bukhari and Muslim, it is reported that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 1*2 t L> lojljl 4,rtg'.h a-Z\jS jLJ tl 1_sr-di O-SLJil ul IdOjf ilijj «When anyone of you goes to bed, let him brush down the bed with his garment, for he does not know what has come on his bed since he left it. Then let him say, "In Your Name, O Lord, I lay down my side and in Your Name I raise it up; if You take my soul, have mercy on it, and if You send it back, protect it with that which You protect Your righteous servants. He keeps those (souls) for which He has ordained death} means, those which have died, and He returns the others back for an appointed term. As-Suddi said, "For the rest of their lives."121 Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "He keeps the souls of the dead and sends back the souls of the living, and He does not make any mistakes. iVerily, in this are signs for a people who think deeply.} X) \y\— J jJl j» ilaii oj> 4 ill Jif, liVy ifjbjiij »" <il£ % iiiLlll <£ Ji 111 Path Al-Bari 1 1 :130 , Muslim 4:2084 121 At-Tabari 21 :298.

£ 'k * <>S3 ob% V :S 4»j2 ijtii &S y / * »/#/ 443. Have they taken as intercessors besides Allah? Say: "Even if they have power over nothing whatever and have no intelligence?"} 444. Say: "To Allah belongs all intercession. His is the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth. Then to Him you shall be brought back."} 445. And when Allah Alone is mentioned, the hearts of those who believe not in the Hereafter are filled with disgust and when those besides Him are mentioned, behold, they rejoice!} There is no Intercession except with Allah, and how the Idolators are filled with Disgust when Allah is mentioned alone Allah condemns the idolators for taking intercessors besides Allah, namely the idols and false gods whom they have taken on the basis of their own whims, with no evidence or proof. These idols are not able to do anything; they have no minds with which to think, and they cannot hear or see. They are inanimate and are much worse off than animals. Then Allah says: 'Say - O Muhammad - to these people who claim that those whom they have taken as intercessors with Allah, that intercession is of no avail except for the one with whom Allah is pleased and to whom He has granted permission to intercede. The whole matter rests with Him.' 4*ii% VI T*X£ ifjt li£} 4Wlw is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} (2:255). 4ufjVL) (iiii \$} 4His is the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth.} means, He is the One Who is in control of all that. *4) 4Then to Him you shall be brought back.}

m tn ii&mm V, means, 'on the Day of < <— [>] Resurrection, then He T' wiU Judee between U-* 5 5 you with His justice, -,c. >> . and He will reward or ^"V -1 '4 * punish each person according to his S? V," , ^57;^ deeds.' Then Allah l^uoli^jvf:Wl3^o>:rsXji>>DUj*^ condemns the g^fe.<J{;-yv idolaters further: 3^2*48^?\$\$ ^ ^ 0ojr^M^y^A^cA l mentioned> means , 3u*foi & when it is said there A - sJt.xV.-.'S-r-y"U"* is no (true) God except Allah Alone, ^ C?if 4l3 /tearls o/ 1/iose ta/io **f Hot. s 7f t ^ after are filled wtht disgust} — — — ..==! l Mujahid said, "Their hearts are filled with disgust means they recoil in horror." This is like the Ayah: &t yi 2\ ~H fi Jj \>[\$? iTruly, when it was said to them: "Ld ildha Hid Allah," they puffed themselves up with pride.} (37:35) which means, they were too proud to follow it. Their hearts could not accept anything good, and whoever cannot accept good will accept evil. Allah says: 4.iEj> ot S> iand when those besides Him are mentioned,} 111 At-Tabari 21 :301.

meaning, the idols and false gods — this was the view of Mujahid - ibehold, they rejoice!} means, they feel happy. ra 4 Cw <uk y% *i Ef A !#S j\$ c ^ ,4 cs £ yisar js if p-jj jii m i46. Say: "O Allah! Creator of the heavens and the earth! All- Knower of the unseen and the seen! You will judge between your servants about that wherein they used to differ."} 447 . And those who did wrong, if they had all that is on the earth and therewith as much again, they verily, would offer it to ransom themselves therewith on the Day ofResurrectionfrom the evil torment; and there will become apparent to them from Allah what they had not been reckoning.} 448. And the evils of that which they earned will become apparent to them, and that which they used to mock at will encircle them.} How to supplicate After condemning the idolaters for their love of Shirk and their hatred of Tawhid, Allah then says: 4Say: "O Allah! Creator of the heavens and the earth! All- Knower of the unseen and the seen!..."} meaning, 'call you upon Allah Alone with no partner or associate, Who has created the heavens and the earth and originated them,' i.e., made them like nothing that ever before existed. 4l^J ySK p£} 4All-Knower of the unseen and the seen!} means, what is secret and what is open.

4You will judge between your servants about that wherein they used to differ.) means, in this world; You will judge between them on the Day when they are resurrected and brought forth from their graves.' In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Abu Salamah bin 'Abdur-Rahman said, "I asked 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, how the Messenger of Allah jg started his prayer when he stood up to pray at night. She said, may Allah be pleased with her: When the Messenger of Allah sg stood up to pray at night, he would start his prayer with the words: L*J i A-j \y\S Ita lit- ojl isl *Jl »LLj I CJL&J vjjLI t .jlolj «O Allah, Lord of Jibril, Mika'il and Israfil, Creator of the heavens and the earth, Knower of the unseen and the seat, You will judge between Your servants concerning that wherein they differ. Guide me with regard to that wherein there is dispute concerning the truth by Your leave, for You guide whomsoever You will to the straight pathy i] NoRansom willbe accepted on the Day ofResurrection %\ %) 4And those who did wrong,) means, the idolaters. ^ ^Vt 4 £) 4if they had all that is in earth and therewith as much again,) 4they verily, would offer it to ransom themselves therewithfrom the evil torment;) means, that which Allah has decreed for them on the Day of Resurrection. But the ransom will not be accepted from them, m Muslim 2 :534

even if it were to be an earth-full of gold as He mentioned elsewhere (3:91). Then Allah says: iand there will become apparent to them from Allah what they had not been reckoning. which means, when they come to realize what Allah's punishment for them will be, which they had never before imagined. ft

\Zf} 4And the evils of that which they earned will become apparent to them,} means, they will see the punishment for the forbidden actions and sins which they committed in this world. 4-^jvr-" . '±1 \s^ 1* (*-r, ^A~j} iand that which they used to mock at will encircle them.} means, the punishment which they used to make fun of in this world will encompass them. 149. When harm touches man, he calls to Us (for help); then when We have changed it into a favorfrom Us, he says : "Only because ofknowledge I obtained it." Nay, it is only a trial, but most ofthan know not!} 150. Verily, those before them said it, yet (all) that they had earned availed than not.} 451. So, the evil results of tlmt which they earned overtook them. And those who did wrong of these will also be overtaken by the evil results for that which they earned; and they will never be able to escape.} 452. Do they not know that Allah expands the provision for

403Surah 39. Az-Zumar (49 - 52) (Part-24) whom He wills, and straitens it. Verily, in this are signs for the folk who believe!} How Man changes when He is blessed after suffering Harm Allah tells us how man, when he is suffering from harm, prays to Allah, turning to Him in repentance and calling upon Him, but when He makes things easy for him, he transgresses and commits sins. ih£ frj U\} iOnly because ofknowledge I obtained it.} means, 'because Allah knows that I deserve it; if it were not for the fact that Allah regards me as special, He would not have given me this.' Qatadah said, "Because I know that I deserve it."11 Allah says: 4^-4 'Jij# iNay, it is only a trial, meaning, the matter is not as he claims; on the contrary, We have blessed him with this as a test to see whether he will be obedient or disobedient - althoughWe have prior knowledge of that.' In fact, it is a trial. 4but most of them know not! So they say what they say and claim what they claim. ot IfM^ iVerily, those before them said it,} means, the previous nations who came before said the same things and made the same claims, \$ X)} iyet (all) that they had earned availed them not.} means, what they said was not right and all that they had gathered did not save them. m At-Tabari 21 :301.

404 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4So, the evil results of that which they earned overtook them. And those who did wrong of these... means, the people who are addressed here, i\p" G iwill also be overtaken by the evil results (torment) for that which they earned;} just as happened to those earlier peoples. 4and they will never be able to escape.> This is like the Ayah in which Allah tells us how Qarun reacted when his people told him: js Vj jQl iil U-j V ill lij Q/U S \ 4 \$ tZb) \$ £21 ^ tilll^^ .^5 0* isxf ^4 \$ jo*/' js j'yjou— Li' 4^: y 4"Do not exidt, verily, Allah likes not those who exult. But seek, with that (wealth) which Allah has bestowed on you, the home of the Hereafter, and forget not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world; and do good as Allah has been good to you, and seek not mischief in the land. Verily, Allah likes not the corrupters." He said: "Tins has been given to me only because of the knowledge I possess." Did he not blow that Allah had destroyed before him generations, men who were stronger than him in might and greater in the amount (of riches) they had collected? But the criminals will not be questioned of their sins."} (28:76-78). And Allah says: £ Cj I'A& & i&> 4And they say: "We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished."} (34:35). 4'JjZJ %)\ £1 t£LS\$} 4Do they not know that Allah expands the provision for whom

405Surah 39. Az-Zumar (53 -59) (Part-24) jr lAo mmm He wills, and straitens it.} means, He gives plenty to some and restricts the provision for others. /A *4\$ j 5^ x s- * *.» iVerily, in this are signs for the folk who believe!} means, there is a lesson and proof. \$ Ot 'j ^1 Afr vyl1' -if jj cJl&& ji J ^5 0* 2 !

453 . Say : "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah, verily, Allah forgives all sins. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful." } 454. "And turn in repentance (and in obedience with true faith) to your Lord and submit to Him before the torment comes upon you, (and) then you will not be helped." } 455. "And follow the best of that which is sent down to you from your Lord, before the torment comes on you suddenly

406 Tafsir Ibtī KathTr while you perceive not!" } 456. Lest a person should say: "Alas, my grief that I was undutiful to Allah, and I was indeed among those who mocked." } 457. Or (lest) he should say: "If only Allah had guided me, I should indeed have been among those who have Taqwa." } 458. Or (lest) he should say when he sees the torment: "If only I had another chance, then I should indeed be among the doers of good." } 459. Yes! Verily, there came to you My Aydt and you denied them, and were proud and were among the disbelievers. } The Call to repent before the Punishment comes This Ayah is a call to all sinners, be they disbelievers or others, to repent and turn to Allah. This Ayah tells us that Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, will forgive all the sins of those who repent to Him and turn back to Him, no matter what or how many his sins are, even if they are like the foam of the sea. This cannot be interpreted as meaning that sins will be forgiven without repentance, because Shirk can only be forgiven for the one who repents from it. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said that some of the people of Shirk killed many people and committed Zina, (illegal sexual acts) to a great extent; they came to Muhammad jg and said, "What you are saying and calling us to is good; if only you could tell us that there is an expiation for what we have done." Then the following Ayat were revealed: Sf) jpJlf ii* fr- J*' V Lt\$} } 4And those tuho invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause, nor commit illegal sexual intercourse} (25:68). 4t\$ iij-j ot p (...ail 4Say: "O My servants wlv have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah. }

This was also recorded by Muslim, Abu Dawud and An- Nasa1. [11 What is meant by the first Ayah (25:68) is: ^Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds> (25:70). Imam Ahmad recorded that Asma' bint Yazid, said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg reciting, j* fe iverily, his work is unrighteous} (11:46). And I heard him jg say: jiiij <3ll jj <ut Ji IjlaliJ Y i. jijJl Ji) (Say: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah, verily, Allah forgives all sins He does not reckon him Truly, He is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful). 'W This was also recorded by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi.131 All of these Hadiths indicate that what is meant is that Allah forgives all sins provided that a person repents. Additionally, one must not despair of the mercy of Allah even if his sins are many and great, for the door of repentance and mercy is expansive. Allah says: 2 it y 4Know they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants} (9:104). it if 1 >5 jj pUL jl jUo 4And whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} (4:110). Concerning the hypocrites, Allah says: 111 Fath At-Bari 8:411, Muslim 1 : 1 13 , Abu Dawud 4:166, An-NasST in Al-Kubra 446. Ahmad 6:454. Abu Dawud 4 : 285, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:111.

لجئف < & o? 4-^''' *5^ 4 o»S® 6)£ < terih/, the hypocrites will be in t)\e lowest depth (grade) of the Fire; no helper will you find for them. Except those who repent, and do righteous good deeds (4:145-146). And Allah says: J "Vl Cri «i*yj Si' 3L>\ i£ji' 4£gii4^ ^44 <33 di i^; iSurely, disbelievers are those who said: "Allah is the third of the three (in a Trinity)." But there is no god but One. And if they cease not from what they say , verily, a painful torment will befall on the disbelievers among them.} (5:73). Then He says: iWill they not turn in repentance to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. (5:74) And Allah says: 4Verily, those who put into trial the believing mat and believing women (by torturing them), and then do not turn in repentance (to Allah)} (85:10). Al-Hasan Al-Basri, may Allah have mercy on him, said, "Look at this generosity and kindness! They killed His close friends but He still called them to repentance and forgiveness." There are many Ay&t on this topic. The Two SdhXhs record the Hadith of Abu Said, may Allah be pleased with him, from Messenger of Allah ijg about the man who killed ninety-nine people. Later on, he regretted it and asked a worshipper among the Children of Israel whether he could repent. He told him no, so he killed him, thus completing one hundred. Then he asked one of their scholars whether he could repent. He said, "What is stopping you from repenting?" Then he told him to go to a town where Allah was

worshipped. He set out for that town, but death came to him while he was on the road. The angels of mercy and the angels of punishment disputed over him, so Allah commanded them to measure the distance between the two towns; whichever he was closer to was the one to which he belonged. They found that he was closer to the town he was heading for, so the angels of mercy took him. It was said that when he was dying, he moved himself (towards that town), and Allah commanded the good town to move closer to him and the other town to move away.^{1,1} This is basic meaning of the Hadith, we have quoted it in full elsewhere. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on the Ayah: C}j}\ & oj r& iJ-j oi jje i CSjCcj iSay: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah, verily, Allah forgives all sins..."} Allah invites all to His forgiveness; those who claim that the Messiah is God, those who claim that the Messiah is the son of God, those who claim that TJzayr is the son of God, those who claim that Allah is poor, those who claim that the Hand of Allah is tied up, and those who say that Allah is the third of three (Trinity). Allah says to all of these: iWill they not turn in repentance to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} (5:74). And He calls to repentance the one who says something even worse than that, the one who says, 'I am your Lord most high,' and says, O' oljr. i"I knoiv not that you have a god other than me."} (28:38). Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Anyone who m Fath Al-B&ri 6 :591

«il £L*J jJ !;Jl -L Sil • >i > .*/. t >•!',, « f c i. ' ' " "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, if you were to commit sin until your sins filled the space between heaven and earth, then you were to ask Allah for forgiveness, He would forgive you. By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, if you did not commit sin, Allah would bring other people who would commit sins and then ask Allah for forgiveness so that He could forgive themj'^ This was recorded only by Ahmad. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Ayyub Al-Ansari, may Allah be pleased with him, said, as he was on his deathbed, "I have concealed something from you that I heard from the Messenger of Allah jg; he said: If you did not commit sins, Allah would create people who would sin so that He could forgive them."" This was recorded by Imam Ahmad; it was also recorded by Muslim in his Sahih, and by At-Tirmidhi . Allah encourages His

servants to hasten to repent, as He says: 4\$!A-4j <££> (3i iAnd turn in repentance (and in obedience with true faith) to your Lord and submit to Him} meaning, turn back to Allah and submit yourselves to Him. 4before the torment comes upon you, (and) then you will not be helped.} means, hasten to repent and do righteous deeds before His wrath comes upon you. cJt 4j<1 5-*^ ^y^i} Ahmad 3:238. 121 Ahmad 5:414, Muslim 4 :2105 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :223

3 jl lSjj uw iyu jl ;»Y,iSuIlJI (>; C^£=J iil /"P j) 4^£!DC—All' ££ »J.~ 4L^s/ <? person should say: "Alas, my grief that 1 was undutiful to Allah, and I was indeed among those who mocked." Or he should say: "If only Allah had guided me, 1 should indeed have been among those who have Taqwa." Or he should say wheti he sees the torment : "If only I had another chance, then I should indeed be among the doers ofgood. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: >• a-1p o *I>! 01) : ^jA ojJLLo j jbJt 3^ :<JU 4jil jl Vjj : JjjsO jlljl exiia iSji :JU ij 0j& Each of the people of Hell will be shown his place in Paradise and he will say, "If only Allah had guided me!" so it will be a source of regretfor him. And each of the people ofParadise will be shown his place in Hell and he will say, "If it were not for the fact that Allah guided me," so it will be a cause of thanks It was also narrated by An-Nasa'iJ3' When the sinners wish that they could return to this world so that they could believe the Ayat of Allah and follow His Messengers, Allah will say: iYes! Verily, there came to you My Ayat and you denied them, and were proud and were among the disbelievers> meaning, 'O you who regret what you did, My Ayat did come to you in the world, and My proofwas established against you, but you rejected it and were too arrogant to follow it, and you were among those who disbelieved in it.' At-Jabari 21:316. 121 Ahmad 1 :512. ^ Ahmad no . 10660 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 : 447

J.J* 4 • f+4-byri Lp 44 ^u-ii!' 4 '\$-><!*>>*> r* i*-f—^ -A£>Cuj iyj" ct\$& Jpj P0 460. And on the Day of Resurrection you will see those who lied against Allah - theirfaces will be black. Is there not in Hell an abodefor the arrogant?} 462. And Allah ivill deliver those who have Taqwa to their places of success. Evil shall touch them not, nor shall they grieve The Consequences forThoseWho tell Lies againstAllah and for Those Who have Taqwa Allah tells us that on the Day of Resurrection, some faces will be blackened and some will be whitened. The faces of those who followed splits and divisions will be blackened, and the faces of Ahlus-Sunnah wal-Jama'ah will be whitened. Allah says here: 4ji> jc iiST 'fj'M 44 4And on the Day of Resurrection you will see those who lied against Allah} meaning, by their claims that He had partners or offspring. >> >> V itheir faces will be black.} means, because of their lies and fabrications. jp 4 4/s there not in Hell an abodefor the arrogant?} means, is not Hell sufficient for them as a prison and humiliating final destination, because of their stubborn pride, arrogance and refusal to follow the truth? 4 iyif 0>J)\ US ,Jp.j} }And Allah will deliver tlwse who are those who have Taqwa to their places ofsuccess.} means, because of what Allah has decreed for them of happiness and victory.

iEvil sltall touch them not,} means, on the Day of Resurrection. itior shall they grieve.} means, the greater terror (of that Day) will not cause them grief, for they will be safe from all grief and removed from all evil, and they will attain all that is good. \$\$ -j£ib & 'J& ji £ iiji M j£T y iJ y ojJ' jjj 462. Allah is the Creator of all things, and He is the Trustee over all things.} 463. To Him belong the Maqalid of the heavens and the earth. And those ivho disbelieve in the Aydt of Allah, such are they who will be the

losers .} 464. Say: "Do you order me to worship other than Allah? O you fools!"} 465. And indeed it has been revealed to you, as it was to those before you: "If you join others in worship with Allah, surely your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers."} 466. Nay! But worship Allah, and be among the grateful.} Allah is the Creator and Controller, and associating others in worship with Him cancels out Good Deeds Allah tells us that He is the Creator, Lord, Sovereign and Controller of all things; everything is subject to His dominion, power and guardianship. %} 4To Him belong the Maqalid of the heavens and the earth.} Mujahid said, "Maqalid means Treys' in Persian." This was also the view of Qatadah, Ibn Zayd and Sufyan bin 'Uyaynah. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :243 , At-Tabari 2 1 : 32 1

they used to do would have been of no benefit to them.} (6:88). }Nay! But worship Allah, and be among the grateful.} means, "you and those who follow you and believe in you should make your worship sincerely for Allah Alone, with no partner or associate." if £ JoVfj £ & U53S }67. They made not a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him. And on the Day of Resurrection the whole of the earth will be grasped by His Hand and the heavens will be rolled up in His Right Hand. Glorified be He, and High be He above all that they associate as partners with Him!} The Idolators did not make a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him j»- Sat bjSi Cj} iThey made not a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him.} means, the idolators did not give Allah His due when they worshipped others alongside Him. He is the Almighty, and there is none mightier than Him; He is the One Who is able to do all things; He is the Owner of all things and everything is under His control and power. Mujahid said, "This was revealed concerning Quraysh." As-Suddi said, "They did not venerate Him as He deserves to be venerated." 1 11 Muhammad bin Kah said, "If they had made a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him, they would not have lied." 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: 4 1>- la' [>jji £j} iTitey made not a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him.} m At-Tabari 2 1 :32 1

Sitrah 39. Az-Zumar (67) (Part-24 uAllah will grasp the earth and roll up the heavens in His Right Hand, then He will say : "I am the King, where are the kings of the earth?"n"* 11 This version was recorded only by Al-Bukhari; Muslim recorded another version .*21 Al-Bukhari also recorded from Ibn 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah jg said: olj-vlll j i£^>(SStill fji w 1*:*! iljLj Sill jl» 0 1 / 't 1 xixi' Li . iOku »On the Day of Resurrection, Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, will grasp the earth with one finger, and the heavens will be in His Right Hand, then He will say, "I am the King."*13' This version was also recorded by Al-Bukhari It is recorded that Ibn "Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg recited this Ayah on the Minbar one day: f> £ * "tU' - •" "-if >> <• /C— J **j& <y~ 'JjJ* Ujr && iTitey made not a just estimate of Allah such as is due to Him. On the Day of Resurrection the whole earth will be grasped by His Hand and the heavens will be rolled up in His Right Hand. Glorified be He, and High be He above all that they associate as partners with Him!) The Messenger of Allah gg said while moving his hand forward and backward: y_p\ Ui Uf ut lit O&Jl Ct :Lij L>')\ "And the Lord will glorify Himself, saying "I am Compeller, I am the Proud, I am the King, I am the Mighty, I am the Most |l * Fath Al-Bari 8:413. Muslim 4:2148. •3| Path Al-Bari 13:404.

isWj jjiJ^Vi ^ l^iLJl^*-1^4>-^^JtA4~==><^j'<A?*J JAjj«^J (>4-!Jl3j 2"*-4pS2?ij ^3j9-4^ 5J& tSjr^o-Z-*1^4 4»-<IS>2j\$JlSa-j\J-i^ i68. And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and all who are on the earth will swoon away, except him whom Allah wills. Then it will be blown another time, and behold they will be standing, looking on.) 469. And the earth will shine with the light of its Lord, and the Book will be presented, and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward, and it will be judged between them with truth, and they will not be wronged.) 470. And each person will be paid in full of what he did; and He is Best Aware of what they do.) Generous."» And the Mi,nbar shook so much that we feared that the Messenger of Allah 3g would fall." This was also recorded by Muslim, An-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah.*21 <4 Cr S*~^* jy***' 4 C £ Vi ^Vf ,£3\ bXr^J ^ ?c -A J (V £~ZD x -x if j o#V 5^)-5 (»*j >j 3xS 15 *x« 111 Ahmad 2:72. Muslim 4 :2148, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 4 :400, Ibn Majah 2 :1429.

421 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (68 - 70) (Part-24 The Blast of the Trumpet, the Judgement and the Recompense Allah tells us about the terrors of the Day of Judgement, with its mighty signs and terrifying upheaval. 4 Saf i'll cP 4And the Trumpet will be blown and all who are in the heavens and all who are on the earth will swoon away, except him whom Allah wills.) This will be the second trumpet-blast, which will cause people to die. By this trumpet-blast, everyone who is alive in the heavens and on earth will be caused to die, except for him whom Allah wills. Then the souls of the remaining creatures will be taken, until the last one to die will be the Angel of Death, and there will be left only the Ever Living, Eternal One, Who was there in the beginning and will be at the end, forever. He will say three times, 4 }\$ saxp> 4 "Whose is the kingdom this day?"), then He will answer Himself: 4& to 4 "It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!") (40:16). 1 am the One existing Alone, I subjugated all things and I decreed that all things must come to an end.' Then the first one to be brought back to life will be Israfil, and Allah will command him to sound the Trumpet again. This will be the third trumpet-blast, the trumpet-blast of Resurrection.111 Allah says: 4^IP^ (U% tzA 4Then it will be blown another time, and behold they will be standing, looking on) 111 As explained earlier, the author has based his understanding of this point upon an unauthentic Hadlth. The majority understand these Ayat and the authentic Hadlth to imply two blasts of the Stir. Some of these narrations follow

means, after they have been bones and dust, they will come alive, looking at the terrors of the Day of Resurrection. This is like the Ayat iBut it will be only a single Zajrah,m when behold, they find themselves alive.) (79:13-14) It (tV-Jj 4On f/ie Day when He will call you, and you will respond with His praise, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while!) (17:52), and -i i:'*! U) [T •}y\ u^Vlj lUl pi3 o"l 4And among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command. Then afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth.) (30:25) Imam Ahmad recorded that a man said to 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, "You say that the Hour will come at such and such time." He said, "I thought that I would not narrate to you anymore. All that I said was that after a little while you would see something of great importance." 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: iKtiJ p-fc? lThe Dajjal will emerge in my Ummah and he will stay among them for forty . I do not know whether he said forty days or forty months or forty years or forty nights. *—• ij'j 'J, lill Or*' Cxi 1 Cjzf <&! i^jisll Jlii. iflljl Jct ojlt; U«jj ill jU iSjlji- i*Je- J Jlf XS 'Jt jls of jJ t V~£bi YJ jUjJ fj* ;ji m See the Tafsir of Surat As-Saffat [37 : 19]

423 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (68 - 70) (Part-24) «Then Allah will send 'Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, who resembles 'Urwah bin Mas'ud Ath-Thaqafi, and he will prevail. Allah will destroy him (the Dajjal), then after that mankind will live for seven years with no enmity between any two people. Then Allah will send a cool wind from the direction of Ash-Sham, which will take the soul of every person who has even a speck of faith in his heart; even if one of them were to be inside the heart of a mountain, it would enter upon him.»” He said, “I heard it from the Messenger of Allah: Nj <3jjj*i V j.jai\ <i>- ^ j-? i J> p f t--: *- yJ- lji> il3i j> jljVl (J>-J t < « n i <Jj\j id Vl i jj*udl - J>-j "y. 4)1 f ~ j 4)1 'i>*~® VI V jd iJa-aj £% p i^ilii Su*1 Zf - ou«; iiU jkn ji - JLi! Sfe \$ r ^ ¥^ 4® Sjs£i uThere will be left the most evil of people, as light as birds and with the hard hearts of wild predators. They will not recognize any good or denounce any evil. Then Shaytdn will appear to them and say, “Will you not obey me?” Then he will command them to worship idols and they will worship them. At that time they will have ample provision and a good standard of living. Then the Trumpet will be blown, and no one will hear it but he will tilt his head to listen. The first one to hear it will be a man who is filling his water trough, and he will die when he hears it. Then there will be no one left who has not died. Then Allah will send» - or - send down «rain like drizzle» - or - shade - An-Nu‘man [one of the narrators] was not sure of its wording from which the bodies of the people will grow . Then the Trumpet will be blown once more, and they will be standing, looking on. Then it will be said, "O mankind, come to your Lord, \$But stop them, verily, they are to be questioned} (37:24). Then it will be said,

** -£) JS : Jlili aJU , **p Xj» *u 4 i LyJ> /j i '•* •,/, - . _ - «"Send forth the people of Hell." It will be said, "How many?" It will be said, "From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety- nine." On that Day, children will be resurrected gray-haired, and on that Day the Shin will be laid bare . This was recorded by Muslim in his Sahih. [2 ' Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet jg said: "Oyu'J jZ U» 8Between the two blasts, there will be only forty They said, “O Abu Hurayrah, forty days?” He, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I do not know.” They said, “Forty years?” He said, “I do not know.” They said, “Forty months?” He said, “I do not know.” «jijji 4i>: cjj- vj jubji ji jsJb> «Every part of a man will disintegrate apart from the root of his backbone, and out of that he will be created anew V31 ->A •J'jR cX^f} iAnd the earth will shine with the light of its Lord,} means, it will shine brightly on the Day of Resurrection when the Truth (Allah), may He be glorified and exalted, manifests Himself to His creation, to pass judgement. iand the Book will be presented}. Qatadah said, “The Book of deeds.”141 "&& } iand the Prophets will be brought forward,} Ahmad 2:166. Muslim 4:2257. Fath Al-B&ri 8:414. At-Tabari 21 :335.

425 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (68 - 70) <Part-24) Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “They will bear witness against the nations, testifying that they conveyed the Message of Allah to them.” iatid the witnesses> means, witnesses from among the angels who record the deeds of all, good and evil alike. iand it will be judged between them with truth,} means, with justice. iand they will not be wronged.} Allah says: 4And I've s/ufi setup Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed, We will bring it. And Sufficient are We to take account.} (21:47) '-s' iSurely, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good (done), He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward.} (4:40) Allah says: iclS IS ojZ\$ iAnd each person will be paid in full of what he did;} meaning, of good and evil. j*j} iand He is Best Aware of what they do}. Jtij Qjjll m At-Jabari 2 1 :336

£ f&& pi J4S Uri Qy^»" »«*** Ce'f 9**>' J-j Jfi illf <LjJL- <Jj-* (J-IJ 471. And those who disbelieved will be driven to Hell in groups till when they reach it, the gates thereof will be opened. And its keepers will say: "Did not the Messengers come to you from yourselves, reciting to you the Aydt of your Lord, and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "Yes," but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} 472. It will be said: "Enter you the gates of Hell, to abide therein. And what an evil abode of the arrogant!"}

How the Disbelievers will be driven to Hell

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5011–5023]

Allah tells us how the doomed disbeliever will be driven to Hell by force, with threats and warnings. This is like the Ayah pZ ja dl 0 4The Day when they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing.} (52:13) which means, they will be pushed and forced towards it, and they will be extremely thirsty, as Allah says: p 3i ff Ji oj&K >J&0 4The Day I've shall gather those who luwe Taqwa unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation. And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a thirsty state.} (19:85-86) When they are in that state, they will be blind, dumb and deaf, and some of them will be walking on their faces: •".is fe.: 62: a. i 4V 4and We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell; whenever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire} (17:97).

40^ 'ij 4 till when they reach it, the gates thereof will be opened. means, as soon as they arrive, the gates will be opened quickly, in order to hasten on their punishment. Then the keepers of Hell, who are stem angels, severe and strong, will say to them by way of rebuking and reprimanding: ipi \$¥ iDid not the Messengers come to you from yourselves,} meaning, 'of your own kind, so that you could have spoken to them and learned from them,' 4reciting to you the Ayat of your Lord,} means, 'establishing proof against you that what they brought to you was true,' iand warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?} means, 'warning you of the evil of this Day.' The disbeliever will say to them: iYes,} meaning, they did come to us establish proof and evidence against us,' and warn us and i but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} means, 'but we rejected them and went against them, because we were already doomed, as it was decreed that we would be, because we had turned away from the truth towards falsehood.' This is like the Ayat. 'if# £@&&%&a£\$% jl '£> ptpQ 'J&} ^ 4 S' 6 jii j ££ S' j) 4 VJ,& oj iEvery time a group is cast therein, its keeper will ask: "Did

428 Tafstr Ibn Kathir no wamer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer came to us, but we denied him and said: 'Allah never revealed anything; you are only in great error.'" And they will say: "Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of lire blazing Fire!"} (67:9-10) which means, they will feel regret and will blame themselves. x&} iThen they will confess their sin . So, away with the dwellers of the blazing Fire!} (67:1 1) means, they are lost and doomed. Co? fjto' ilt will be said (to them): "Enter you the gates of Hell, to abide therein .. ."} means everyone who sees them and the situation they are in, will testify that they deserve the punishment. These words are not attributed to any specific person, but they are said as an indication that the entire universe will bear witness that they deserve what they are suffering, in accordance with the judgement of the Most Just, the All-Knowing. Allah says: Co? 'jk-j' ilt will be said (to them) : "Enter you the gates

of Hell, to abide therein .."} meaning, "to stay there forever; you will never leave or depart.' JPpx} iAnd (indeed) what an evil abode of the arrogant!} means, "what an evil destiny and what an evil place to stay, because of your arrogance in this world and your refusal to follow the truth; this is what has led you to this, what an evil state and what an evil final destination!' 'Jx JIji> ChO? CCcij pj iICjl 3} pj i73. And those who had Taqwa will be led to Paradise in

groups till when they reach it, and its gates will be opened and its keepers will say: "Salam 'Alaykum (peace be upon you)! You have done well, so enter here to abide therein forever."} 474. And they will say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah Who has fulfilled His promise to us and has made us inherit the land. We can dwell in Paradise where we will ; how excellent a rewardfor the workers!"} The Believers willbe taken to Paradise Here Allah tells us about the blessed believers, who will be taken to Paradise in groups, one group after another, starting with the best of them: those who are closest to Allah, then the most righteous, then the next best and the next best. Each group will be with others like them, Prophets with Prophets, the true believers with their peers, the martyrs with their counterparts, the scholars with their colleagues, every group composed of people of the same kind. A&jK \$ -&-} itill when they reach it,} means, when they arrive at the gates of Paradise, after passing over the Sirat, where they will be detained on a bridge between Paradise and Hell, and any injustices that existed between them in this world will be settled until they have all been purified from sin through this trial. Then permission will be granted for them to enter Paradise. It was recorded in the Hadith about the Trumpet that when the believers reach the gates of Paradise, they will consult one another as to who should ask permission for them to enter. They will ask Adam, then NUh, then Ibrahim, then Musa, then Isa, then Muhammad ^ (may blessings and peace be upon them all). This is akin to what will happen in the arena of judgement, when they will ask for someone to intercede for them with Allah when He comes to pass judgement. This is to show the noble position of Muhammad sgj above the rest of mankind in all situations. In Sahih Muslim, it is reported that Anas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: qa.: Jjf ut.

432Surah 39. Az-Zumar (73 - 74) (Part-24) heart. They will glorify Allah morning and evening .a"* 1 ' This was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.*2 Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah jg said: pJjy-ljttj 1 ajjl '.ofyjrC djL ^ J*>- 'J* 'Orf •jUiIJJ tThe first group to enter Paradise will look like the moon on the night when it is full. They will be followed by a group which looks like the brightest star shining in the sky. They will not urinate or defecate or spit or blow their noses. Their combs will be ofgold, their sweat will be musk and their censers will be of aloeswood. Their wives will be Al-Hiir Al-'lyn, and they will all look the same, as if they are one person in the image of their father Adam, sixty cubits ta//.»"131 They [Al-Bukhari and Muslim] also produced this from the Hadith of Jabir.*4 It was reported that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah ig said: <lp fjii l S*Li) i Ujl Jjjw> l 'j*j iSA .j* 4-7*11 <jjiii «A group ofmy Ummah, seventy tlwusand, will enter Paradise with their faces shining like the moon on the night when it is full. TJkkashah bin Mihsan stood up and said, 'O Messenger of Allah, pray to Allah to make me one of them.' He said, &*> ^i*>» *'* Ahmad 2:316. 121 Fath Al-Bari 6 :367 , Muslim 4 :2180 131 Abu Yala 10:470. * Fath Al-Bari4:417, Muslim 4:2179.

«O Allah, make him one of them. Then one of the Ansar stood up and said, 'O Messenger of Allah, pray to Allah to make me one of them.' He said, »Ukkashah has beaten you to it.*" This was recorded by (Al-Bukhari and Muslim).¹¹ This Hadith - about the seventy thousand who will enter Paradise without being brought to account - was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Jabir bin 'Abdullah, Imran bin Husayn, Ibn Mastid, Rifa'ah bin 'Arabah Al-Juhani and Umm Qays bint Mihsan - may Allah be pleased with them all - and also from Abu HSzim from Sahl bin Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with them, who said that the Messenger of Allah% said: 'i ft-'" 1 ' 1?* - j5U»r^ jf - ll)l iiyLi. jf f fjt <L»JI ^jUJd« «^i in y&\ ijX jii;> aSeventy thousand or seven hundred thousand of my Ummah will surely enter Paradise, holding on to one another, such that the first and last of them will enter Paradise together, with their faces looking like the moon on the night when it is full.b"*²¹ itill when they reach it, and its gates will be opened and its keepers will say: "Salam 'Alaykum (peace be upon you)! You have done well, so enter here to abide therein forever."} This is a conditional sentence that is not complete. What it implies is that when they come to the gates of Paradise the gates will be opened for them as a sign of honor, and the angelic gatekeepers will meet them with glad tidings, greetings of peace and praise. Unlike the gatekeepers of Hell who will meet the disbelievers with rebuke and reprimand, the believers will be filled with happiness and joy, each according to his 111 Path Al-B&ri 11 :413, Muslim 1 :197. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 11:414, Muslim 1 :197.

degree of luxuuiy and delights. What happens after this is not mentioned; it is left for the imagination to think of its dearest wishes and be filled with hope. It is known from the Sahih Hadiths that Paradise has eight gates. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: icAJl j* «iil Jr- Ji. du IjA JJfjj JaI I J o^AjoJl J*i jl£ Ji Ij*j ^1? If « j» ^pa j* j*j oWhoever spends a pair of something from his wealth for the sake of Allah, will be called from the gates of Paradise. Paradise has (several) gates. Whoever is among the people of prayer, will be called from the gate of Prayer; whoever is among the people of charity, will be called from the gate of Charity ; whoever is among the people of Jihad, will be called from the gate of Jihad; whoever is among the people of fasting, will be called from the Gate of Ar-Rayyany Abu Bakr said, 'O Messenger of Allah, it does not matter from which gate one is called, but will anyone be called from all of them?' He sgj said, >• '. y. •.{ > «Yes, and I hope that you will be one of them . o"* 1 Something similar was also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim . It was reported from Sahl bin Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of AMh jg said: iU-i: v i i£. 4^' Ji «J« Paradise there are eight gates; one of them is called Ar- Rayyan, and no one will enter it except those who fast.*' In Sahih Muslim, it is recorded that TJmar bin Al-Khattab, may 111 Ahmad 2:268. 121 Fath Al-Bari⁴ :133 , Muslim 2 :71 1 131 Fath Al-Bari 6 :378 , Muslim 2 :808

435 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (73 - 74) (Part-24) them that the distance between the two gateposts of Paradise was the distance of a forty-year journey, but there would come a day when they would be packed with crowds of people. Allah says, <£LP-& iand its keepers will say: "Saldm 'Alaykum (peace be upon you)! You have done well,"} meaning, "your deeds and words were good, and your efforts were good, and your reward is good.' The Messenger of Allah 3g issued commands during some of his military campaigns that it should be shouted out to the Muslims: itfji - j,ijj jj - liUi; i SJi l\» aNo one enters Paradise except a Muslim souh or, according to one report, «A believing sow/.»"² ' Allah says, iUp~ iso enter here to abide therein forever.} means, to dwell therein, never seeking any change. vijJ'

And they will say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah Who has fulfilled His promise to us.. ." means, when the believers see the great reward and splendors, blessing and grand generosity, they will say, "All the praises and thanks be to Allah Who has fulfilled His promise to us" meaning, "the promise which He made to us through His Messengers who called us to this in the world." 'll jv .jA\ ^ 'fj L iOur Lord! Grant us what You promised unto us through 111 Muslim 4:2278. 121 Fath Al-Bari 11 :385.

437 Surah 39. Az-Zumar (75) (Part-24) In the Two Sahihs, it was reported in the story of the Mi'raj which was narrated by Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Prophet said: lf-i liyi liLjJl oJU-ifu >4iy) bp lyjjisi LiLf. «J was admitted into Paradise where I saw that its domes were pearls and its soil was musky / f jt < iji (*jjj oy*i~i Ji0 Jj*- (*r? (ifO 475. And you will see the angels surrounding the Throne from all round, glorifying the praises of their Lord. And they will be judged with truth. And it will be said, "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} Allah tells us how He will pass judgement on the people of Paradise and Hell, and put each of them in the place fitting for him and for which he is suited; this is justice from Him and He is never unjust. Then He tells us of His angels who surround His majestic Throne, glorifying the praises of their Lord, extolling and magnifying Him, and declaring Him to be above any shortcomings or injustice whatsoever, for He has passed judgement in the fairest and most just manner. He says: 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :547 , Muslim 1 :148.

4(*r? iAnd they will be judged} meaning, all of creation. iwith truth.} Then He says: ifjfx*ft ai Aif iAnd it will be said, "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} meaning, all of creation, whether animate or inanimate, will speak words of praise to Allah, the Lord of all that exists, for His wisdom and justice. These words are not attributed to any specific speaker, which indicates that the whole of creation will testify to His praise. Qatadah said, "Allah began His creation with praise, as He said, iAll praises and thanks be to Allah, Wlw created the heavens and the earth} (6:1). and He ended it with praise, as He says: 4U&£ k&S Jij \$1 iAnd they will be judged with truth. And it will be said, "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists."}" m Al-Tabari 21 :344.

Surah 40: Ghafir

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5024]

Opening The TafslrofSurah Ghafir" (Chapter - 40)

Which was revealed inMakkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5024–5095]

The Virtues ofthe Surahs that begin withHaMim Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “Everything has an essence and the essence of the Qur’an is the family of Ha Mim,” or he said, “the Ha Mans.”*2 ' Mis'ar bin Kidam said, “They used to be called “the brides’.”*3 All of this was recorded by the the Imam, great scholar, Abu TJayd Al-Qasim bin Sallam, may Allah have mercy upon him, in his book Fada’il Al-Qur’an.W Humayd bin Zanjuyah narrated that ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The parable of the Qur’an is that of a man who sets out to find a place for his family to stay, and he comes to a place where there is evidence of rainfall. While he is walking about, admiring it, he suddenly comes upon beautiful gardens. He says, *1 liked the first traces of rainfall, but this is far better.’ It was said to him, The first place is like the Qur’an, and these beautiful gardens are like the splendor of family ofHa Mim in relation to the rest of the Qur’an’.” This was recorded by Al-Baghawi. [sl Ibn Mas’ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When I reach the family of Ha Mim, it is like reaching a beautiful garden, so I take my time.”*61 4-Sgfl P * ^ In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ' This Surah is also known as Al-Mu’min. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :268 131 Al-Qurtubi 15:288. pp. 137, 138. Al-Baghawi 4 :90 ' Al-Baghawi 4 :90

4\ %AAV £fif^ 41 . Ha Mtm.} 42. The revelation of the Book isfrom Allah, the Almighty, the All-Knower.} The Forgiver of sin, the Acceptor of repentance, the Severe in punishment, the Bestower. La ilaha ilia Huwa, to Him is the final return.} We have already discussed the individual letters at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat the discussion here. In a Hadith recorded by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi from one who heard it from the Messenger of Allah jgj, it says: n jj- ijiji Hji^ iji ‘When you go to bed tonight, recite Ha MTm, Yunsarun.*’ Its chain of narrators is Sahih La 4The revelation of the Book is from Allah, the Almighty, the All-Knower.} means, this book - the Qur’an - is from Allah, the Owner of might and knowledge, Who cannot be overtaken and from Whom nothing is hidden, not even an ant concealed beneath many layers. \$3 j&} 4The Forgiver ofsin, the Acceptor of repentance,} means, He forgives sins that have been committed in the past, and He accepts repentance for sins that may be committed in the future, from the one who repents and submits to Him.

Ji-&} 4the Severe in punishment,} means, to the one who persists in ^ Abu Dtwud 3:74, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 5 :329

transgression and prefers the life of this world, who stubbornly turns away from the commands of Allah and commits sin. This is like the Ayah: JV? 4.031£4^% -y - - 4Declare unto My servants that truly I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most-Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.> (15:49-50). These two attributes (mercy and punishment) are often mentioned together in the Qur'an, so that people will remain in a state of both hope and fear. ithe Bestower.} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "This means He is Generous and Rich (Independent of means)."11 * The meaning is that He is Most Generous to His servants, granting ongoing blessings for which they can never sufficiently thank Him. ji' 4And ifyou would count the favors ofAllah, never could you be able to count them .. .> (16: 18). 4La ilaha ilia Huwa) means, there is none that is equal to Him in all His attributes; there is no God or Lord besides Him. &1^ ito Him is the final return> means, all things will come back to Him and He will reward or punish each person according to his deeds. iand He is Swift at reckoning^ (13:41). 4 qy!' \$ v4'* zj Jjif. V-&Q. £>i m At-Tabari 21 :351

Zs3i\ jy ci> liij'Sj d? (jii 4j 4^^ 122T 44 . None disputes in the Ayat of Allah but those who disbelieve. So let not their ability ofgoing about here and there through the land (for their purposes) deceive you!} 45. The people of Niih and the groups after them denied before these; and every nation plotted against their Messenger to seize him, and disputed by means offalsehood to refute therewith the truth. So I seized them, and how wasMy punishment!} 46 . Thus has the Word ofyour Lord been justified against those who disbelieved, that they will be the dwellers of the Fire.} One of the Attributes of the Disbelievers is That they dispute the Ayat of Allah - and The Consequences of that Allah tells us that no one rejects or disputes His signs after clear proof has come, ibut those who disbelieve}, i.e., those who reject the signs of Allah and His proofand evidence. iAS 4 l£> %} 4S0 let not their ability of going about here and there through the land deceive you!} means, their wealth and luxurious life. This is like the Ayah jXj 4& U& iLet not the free disposal (and affluence) of the disbelievers throughout the land deceive you. A briefenjoyment; then, their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that placefor rest.} (3:196-197) iWe let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment.} (31:24).

Then Allah consoles His Prophet Muhammad jg for the rejection of his people. He tells him that he has an example in the Prophets who came before him, may the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them all, for their nations disbelieved them and opposed them, and only a few believed in them. 4The people ofNiih denied before theseft Nuh was the first Messenger whom Allah sent to denounce and forbid idol worship. oi ^ iand the groups after thenft means, from every nation. iand every (disbelieving) nation plotted against their Messenger to seize himft means, they wanted to kill him by any means possible, and some ofthem did kill their Messenger. iand disputed by means of falsehood to refute therewith the truthft means, they came up with specious arguments with which to dispute the truth which was so plain and clear. 4So I seized them^ means, 1 destroyed them, because of the sins they committed.' 4Vlie iand how was My punishmentft means, *how have you heard that My punishment and vengeance was so severe and painful.' Qatadah said, "It was terrible, by Allah."111 iThus has the Word of your Lord been justified against those who disbelieved, that they will be the dwellers of the Fireft At-Tabari 21:353.

' .v.;/f > * > »|/' /, / * > .» < • > \$! # s. , t.f , \ > ,, ~ - ; r • *. < > V r ' c ^ i o S y ^ ' J > * y - 3 z > j i ' £ = £ > m a m m % i means, 'just as the Word of punishment was justified against those of the past nations who disbelieved, so too is it justified against these disbelievers who have rejected you and gone against you, O Muhammad, and it is even more justified against them, because if they have disbelieved in you, there is no certainty that they will believe in any other Prophet.' And Allah knows best. 'Ay- yj # S » ' o & y \$ > K A • • ' * * , < A * % m - V P (W y ° S * 7 ~ i L j j ! > - * * S y l i m < * * » j i & * & & & < Z S S S ! * > i i * J « V 5 ^ (* * £ ' * < > * 0 ^ r * ^ j y j ' £ - ^ 4 ' ^ ^ v J * y * * r ^ < ? ^ 47. Those (angels) who bear the Throne (of Allah) and those around it glorify the praises of their Lord, and believe in Him, and ask forgiveness for those who believe (saying): "Our Lord! You comprehend all things in mercy and knowledge, so forgive those who repent and follow Your way, and save them from the torment of the blazing Fire!" 48. Our Lord! And make them enter the 'Adn (Eternal) Gardens which you have promised them - and to the righteous among their fathers, their wives, and their offspring! Verily, You are the Almighty, t f t e A l l - W i s e . }

445 Surah 40. Ghafir (7 - 9) (Part-24) ^ 9. And save them from the sins, and whomsoever You save from the sins that Day, him verily, You have taken into mercy." And that is the supreme success.} The Bearers of the Throne praise Allah and pray for forgiveness for the Believers Allah tells us that the angels who are close to Him, the bearers of the Throne, and the angels who are around Him - all glorify the praises of their Lord. They combine glorification {Tasbih} which implies that He is free of any shortcomings, with praise (Tahmud) which is an affirmation of praise. 4 and believe in Him,} means, they humbly submit themselves before Him. 4 and ask forgiveness for those who believe means, for those among the people of earth who believe in the Unseen. Allah commanded that His angels who are close to Him should pray for the believers in their absence, so it is a part of the angels' nature that they say Amin when a believer prays for his brother in his absence. In Sahih Muslim it says: ill\j j S \ : i l O J l i j k U S I S I » u When a Muslim prays for his brother in his absence, the angel says, 'Amin, and may you have something similar to it'. # " 111 Shahr bin Hawshab said, "The bearers of the Throne are eight; four of them say, 'Glory and praise be to You, O Allah, to You be praise for Your forbearance after Your knowledge.' Four of them say, 'Glory and praise be to You, O Allah, to You be praise for Your forgiveness after Your power.' When they pray for forgiveness for those who believe, they say: j i - ^ 5 & £ > i Our Lord! You comprehend all things in mercy and knowledge,} m Muslim 4 : 2094

* * - \ S \ ' • / < / i f • / v ^ ^ (* * » - * * > & o J * H J T l i l i l 40 « r Lord! And make them enter the 'Adn (Eternal) Gardens which you have promised them - and to the righteous among their fathers, their wives, and their offspring! Verily, You are the Almighty, the A / - W i s e . Mutarrif bin 'Abdullah bin Ash-Shikhkhilr said, "The most sincere of the servants of Allah towards the believers are the angels." Then he recited this Ayah: i Our Lord! And make them enter the 'Adn (Eternal) Paradises which you have promised them > He then said, "The most treacherous of the servants of Allah towards the believers are the Shaydtn." ! 21 > > i ' c J s S i l f i 4 You are the Almighty, the A l l - W i s e . } means, 'the One Whom none can resist or overwhelm; what You will happen and what You do not will does not happen; You are Wise in all that You say and do, in all that You legislate and decree.' 4 And save them from the sins, means, the actions and the consequences. 4 and whomsoever You save from the sins that Day,} means, the Day of Resurrection, i h i m v e r i l y , Y o u l u i v e t a k e n i n t o m e r c y . } means, 'You have protected him and saved him from punishment.' m At-Tabari 21 : 357. Al-Qurtubi 15 : 295.

4And that is the supreme success.} X h ,u^i mmdx. X j-f* llplij lli/iS yviiiit VJ.ijJj jji"" til 1_>Sli [r# *#i 4/4 /^*-J ufJ *4 (Xi'i oi £j£»- t;j^ *o» s? ft ^ ftJ. &\ k fEK •/ jj>^ 5 <*-££ j^g ^^ 410. Tlwse who disbelieve will be addressed: "Indeed, Allah's aversion was greater towards you than your aversion toward yourselves, when you were called to the Faith but you used to refuse."} ill. Tfjey will say: "Our Lord! You have made us to die twice, and You have given us life twice! Now we confess our sins, then is there any way to get out?"} 412. (It will be said): "This is because, when Allah Alone was invoked, you disbelieved; but when partners were joined to Him, you believed! So the judgement is only with Allah, the Most High, the Most Great!"} 413. It is He Who shows you His Aydt and sends down provision for you from the sky. And none remembers but those who turn in repentance.} 414. So, call you upon Allah making religion sincerely for Him, however much the disbelievers may hate.} The Regret of the Disbelievers after They enter Hell Allah tells us that the disbelievers will feel regret on the Day of Resurrection, when they enter Hell and sink in the agonizing depth of fire. When they actually experience the unbearable punishment of Allah, they will hate themselves with the utmost hatred, because of the sins they committed in the past, which were the cause of their entering the Fire. At that point the angels will tell them in a loud voice that Allah's hatred towards them in this world, when Faith was offered to them and they rejected it, is greater than their hatred towards

449Surah 40. Ghdfir (10- 14) (Part-24) themselves in this situation. Qatadah said, concerning the Ayah: jl ^SLliil Crt 4Indeed, Allah's aversion zoos greater towards you than your aversion toward yourselves, when you were called to the Faith but you used to refuse.} "Allah's hatred for the people of misguidance - when Faith is presented to them in this world, and they turn away from it and refuse to accept it - is greater than their hatred for themselves when they see the punishment of Allah with their own eyes on the Day of Resurrection." ' This was also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Mujahid, As-Suddi, Dharr bin Tjbaydullah Al-Hamdani, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari, may Allah have mercy on them all.*2 4^jj' til 1 iThey will say : "Our Lord! You have made us to die twice, and You have given us life twice!..."} Ath-Thawri narrated from Abu Ishaq from Abu Al-Ahwas from Ibn Mas'fid, may Allah be pleased with him: "This Ayah is like the Ayah: *41 p p p jib 4How can you disbelieve in Allah? Seeing that you were dead and He gave you life. Then He will give you death, then again will bring you to life and then unto Him you will return.}"(2:28)*3 This was also the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and Abu Malik.*4 * This is undoubtedly the correct view. What is meant by all of this is that when they are standing before Allah in the arena of Resurrection, the disbelievers will ask to go back, as Allah says: 111 At-Tabari 21 :359. ' At-Tabari 21 :358, 359. ' At-Tabari 21 :360. ' At-Tabari 21 :360.

L^jtj i >*j lij; >4jJ Xc \y^ ifyou only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) : "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back, that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} (32:12), However, they will get no response. Then when they see the Fire and they are held over it and they look at the punishments therein, they will ask even more fervently than before to go back, but they will get no response. Allah says: S. if oi "tj Iji ijllii jl3l Je lyj) Is} JJJ} •u* ijfQ l)>iJ {}'£ \$ j5 oi Vyjc ijX' \Z fl \f iff you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say : "Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Ayat of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to them what they had been concealing before. But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to

that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.} (6:27-28). When they actually enter Hell and have a taste of its heat, hooked rods of iron and chains, their plea to go back will be at its most desperate and fervent: U lii==> jX)} J/TsStj. •i ^ , .< *> >' > . </y u^llUJJ U-3 l/J-U JX3 CS x* j±=>JZ4~ ^Therein they will cry : “Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not that we used do.” (Allah will reply): "Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you. So taste you. For the wrongdoers there is no helper.”} (35:37) \2_ii JI5 ^ d>l» Lj^ iOur Lord! Bring us out of this. If ever we return (to evil), then indeed we shall be wrongdoers." He (Allah) will say: "Remain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!}}

451 Surah 40. GhdHr (10 - 14) (Part-24) (23:108). According to this Ayah, they will speak more eloquently, and they will introduce their plea with the words: oCiil til 4Our Lord! You have made us to die twice, and You have given us life twice!} meaning, *by Your almighty power, You have brought us to life after we were dead, then You caused us to die after we were alive; You are able to do whatever You will. We confess our sins and admit that we wronged ourselves in the world,’ 4then is there any way to get out?} means, Swill You answer our prayer to send us back to the world, for You are able to do that, so that we might do deeds different from those which we used to do? Then if we go back to our former ways, we will indeed be wrongdoers.’ The response will be: There is no way for you to go back to the world.’ Then the reason for that will be given: Tour nature will not accept the truth and be governed by it, you would reject it and ignore it.’ Allah says: (£> rij.1 4(It will be said): "This is because, when Allah Alone was invoked (in worship), you disbelieved; but when partners were joined to Him, you believed!"} meaning, ‘if you were to go back, this is how you would be.’ This is like the Ayah: 4But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that when they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars} (6:28). 4j&\&&&\$&} 4So the judgement is only with Allah, the Most High, the Most Great!} means, He is the Judge of His creation, the Just Who is never

452 Tafslr Ibn Kathir unjust. He guides whomsoever He wills and sends astray whomsoever He wills; He has mercy on whomsoever He wills and punishes whomsoever He wills; there is no God except Him. '£} 4It is He Who shows you His Aydt} means, He demonstrates His power to His servants through the mighty signs which they see in His creation, above and below, which indicate the perfection of its Creator and Originator. iand sends down provision far you from the sky. this refers to rain, through which crops and fruits are brought forth, which with their different colors, tastes, fragrances and forms are a sign of the Creator. It is one kind of water, but by His great power He makes all these things different. 4And none remembers^ means, no one learns a lesson or is reminded by these things, or takes them as a sign of the might of the Creator, i but those who turn in repentance.} which means, those who have insight and turn to Allah, may He be blessed and exalted. The Believers are commanded to worship Allah Alone no matter what Their Circumstances :J jj; ourf a at \j&} 4So, call you upon Allah making religion sincerely far Him, however much the disbelievers may hate.} This means, worship Allah and call upon Him alone in all sincerity. Do not be like the idolaters in conduct and beliefs. Imam Ahmad recorded that after ending every prayer, ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr used to say: “There is no (true) God except Allah Alone with no partner or associate, His is the dominion and praise, for He is able to do all things; there is no strength and no power except with Allah; there is no (true)

God except Allah and we worship none but Him; to Him belongs the blessings and the virtue and good praise; there is no (true) God except Allah, we worship Him in all sincerity even though the disbelievers may hate that.” He said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to say Tahiti with this after every prayer.” 11 Something similar was also recorded by Muslim, Abu Dawud and An- Nasal. It was reported in Sahih from Ibn Az- Zubayr, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to say the following after the prescribed (obligatory) prayers: *SJ ‘iJ V Sbi Vi v» iEs\ 3 cot;! vj vi ag v uu V) l’J ij v oJ% jjjJ l 3 <i>l V) i3j V hull iJj jJalii* “There is no (true) God except Allah Alone with no partner or associate, His is the dominion and praise, for He is able to do all things; there is no strength and no power except with Allah; there is no (true) God except Allah and we worship none Ahmad 4:4. Tahiti is to say, “La ilaha illall&h” or its like in meaning I2 * Muslim 1 :416, Abu Dawud 2:173, An-Nasal 3:78, 79.

455 Surah 40. Ghdfir (15 - 17) (Part-24 thousand year long journey and its height above the seventh earth is the distance of a fifty thousand years long journey. 4-si& o* && *tA otqA (Jk} \$He sends the revelation of His command to any of His servants He wills,} This is like the Ayat. 'J ,*3 tui' (ji iii a* & -)A of £>Ai Jju} 4He sends down the angels with the Rihi (revelation) of His command to whom of His servants He wills (saying) : "Warn mankind that none has the right to be worshipped but I, so have Taqwa of Me."} (16:2), and o* <iU» Jp qU' ft ij* if)} }And truly, this is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists, Which the trustworthy Rfth (Jibril) has brought down Upon your heart that you may be (one) of the warners.} (26:192- 194) Allah says: fj? jA{ } 4that he may warn (men) of the Day of Mutual Meeting.} ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said: “The Day of Mutual Meeting is one of the names of the Day of Resurrection, of which Allah warns His servants.” ' That is the Day when everyone will find out about his deeds, good and bad. iThe Day when they will come out, nothing of them will be hidden from Allah.} means, they will all appear in the open, with nothing to give them shelter or shade, or cover them. Allah says: 111 At-Tabari 21 :364.

iThe Day when they will come out, nothing of them will be hidden from Allah.} meaning, everything will be equally known to Him. ij\$ k j£*t iiliff£} iWhose is the kingdom this Day? It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!} We have already mentioned the Hadith of Ibn Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah will roll up the heavens and the earth in His Hand and will say, 'J s'j/j£Ji 'J i;\ sfszji iii uf .jiuii «"/ am the King, I am the Compeller, I am the Proud, where are the kings of the earth? Where are the tyrants? Where are the proud?"*W In the Hadith about the Trumpet, it says that Allah will take the souls of all of His creatures, and there will be none left but Him Alone, with no partner or associate. Then He will say, “Whose is the kingdom today?” three times, and He will answer Himself by saying, ij& & 4It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!}^ meaning, He is the Only One Who has subjugated all things. iThis Day shall every person be recompensed for what he earned. This Day no injustice (shall be done to anybody). Truly, Allah is swift in reckoning.} Here Allah tells us of His justice when He judges between His creation; He does not do even a speck of dust's weight of injustice, whether it be for good or for evil. For every good deed He gives a tenfold reward and for every bad deed He gives recompense of one bad deed. Allah says: 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :413, Muslim no. 7051 , At-Tabari 21 :327. At-Tiivalp . 270. This is a lengthy text which is not authentic.

457 Surah 40. Ghafir (18 - 20) (Part-24) 4 This Day no injustice (shall be done to anybody).} It was reported in SahJh Muslim from Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah sg said that Allah said: j! - ^ 'j* ptii Ji u» i Laljl l*JI U — Jb» ji VI >illi j!P iij iljLj 3)1 -UjxJj l^>- «"0 My servants, I have forbidden injustice for Myself, and made it unlawful for you, so do not commit injustice to one another ..."> up to: «"0 My servants, these are your deeds, I record them for you then I will recompense you for them. Whoever finds something good, let him give praise to Allah, and whoever finds something other than that, let him blame no one but himself."^ 4 Truly , Allah is swift in reckoning.} means. He will bring all His creation to account as if He is bringing just one person to account. This is like the Ayah: vi % fiSL } The creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only as a single person} (31:28). 4 And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.} (54:50) V) fsf" ji Ojd.'hll C iSjj vi>b^ j?l yjjVf Ot Oij&Jy Jpi. jj I ^ISI ji Sii t>l jjiaij V 418. And warn them of the Day that is drawing near, when i*i Muslim 4 :1994.

459 Surah 40. Ghafv (18 - 20) (Part-24 places." * This was also the view of Ikrimah, As-Suddi and others. iKdzimin} means silent, for no one will speak without His permission: ikkk &j\ 34 *icM vh \$\$ \$} 4 The Day that Ar-Riih (Jibril) and the angels will stand forth in rows, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious allows, and he will speak what is right.} (78:38). Ibn Jurayj said: iKdzimin "It means weeping."*2 'ot ^ i There will be no friend, nor an intercessor for the wrongdoers, who could be given heed to.} means, those who wronged themselves by associating others in worship with Allah, will have no relative to help them and no intercessor who can plead on their behalf; all means of good will be cut off from them. 4'k lij oJiVl 4 Allah knows the fraud of the eyes, and all that the breasts conceal.} Allah tells us about His complete knowledge which encompasses all things, great and small, major and minor, so that people will take note that He knows about them and they will have the proper sense of shyness before Allah. They will pay attention to the fact that He can see them, for He knows the fraud of the eyes, even if the eyes look innocent, and He knows what the hearts conceal. Ad-Dahhak said: At-Tabari 21:368. 121 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :28 1

the fraud of the eyes,} "A wink and a man saying that he has seen something when he has not seen it, or saying that he has not seen it when he did see it."* 11 Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Allah knows when the eye looks at something, whether it wants to commit an act of betrayal or not."*2 * This was also the view of Mujahid and Qatadah . 131 Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on the Ayah Jii- Cj} iatid all that the breasts conceal.^ "He knows, if you were able to, whether you would commit Zina with a woman or not."*41 As- Suddi said: iand all that the breasts conceal.} meaning, of insinuating whispers. iAnd Allah judges with truth,} means, He judges with justice. Al- A'mash narrated from Said bin Jubayr from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that this Ayah means: "He is able to reward those who do good with good and those who do evil with evil."151 ill 4 Certainly, Allah! He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer.} This is how it was interpreted by Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him. This is like the Ayah: £3 ^ \$%%} i that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with what is best} (53:31). 111 Al-Qurtubi 15:303. At-Tabari 21 :369. At-Tabari 21 :370. At-Tabari 21 :369. At-Tabari 21 :369.

4-zf Ji {while those to whom they invoke besides Him,} means, the idols and false gods, 4*^ ^} i cannot judge anything.} means, they do not possess anything and they cannot judge anything. 4JL4» yzti> l\}

4Certainly, Allah! He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer.} means. He hears all that His creatures say and He knows all about them, so He guides whomsoever He wills and sends astray whomsoever He wills. And He judges with perfect justice in all of that. j-j j»A Ijtf ^ [yft cyi' iic GiS Jfjii j !{*J pj} ie it ^Vf ^ »j* (*Ei ixL cidu ^^ jEl ^U;S 421 . Haw they not traveled in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them ? They were superior to them in strength, and in the traces in the land. But Allah seized them with punishment for their sins. And none had they to protect themfrom Allah.} 412. That was because there came to them their Messengers with clear evidences but they disbelieved (in them). So Allah seized them. Verily, He is All-Strong, Severe in punishment.} The Severe Punishment for the Disbelievers 4Have they not traveled}, these people who disbelieve in your Message, O Muhammad,' 4^+M Crt !y^ vM [s&i JejJi <4^ 4in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them?}}

means, the nations of the past who disbelieved in their Prophets (peace be upon them), for which the punishment came upon them even though they were stronger than Quraysh. id#> 4 iand in the traces in the land.} means, they left behind traces in the earth, such as structures, buildings and dwellings which these people (i.e., the Quraysh] cannot match. This is like the Ayat tLi j&j} iAnd indeed We had firmly established them with that wherewith We have not established you!} (46:26) li*MJ t iand they tilled the earth and populated it in greater numbers than these have done} (30:9). Yet despite this great strength, Allah punished them for their sin, which was their disbelief in their Messengers. iAnd none had they to protect themfrom Allah.} means, they had no one who could protect them or ward off the punishment from them. Then Allah mentions the reason why He punished them, and the sins which they committed. Allah says: iThat was because there came to them their Messengers with clear evidences} meaning with clear proof and definitive evidence. ibut they disbelieved.} means, despite all these signs, they disbelieved and rejected the Message. 4So Allah seized them.} means, He destroyed them utterly, and a

463Surah 40. Chafir (23 - 27) (Part-24) J IV- mm lsj'yaJS&Xiju* Jls> ^==Cjj <3laj gi^^3^3isj0 i&k&k U tib (j)Jj OilJLJi\$3tl*.J14_Jijli ^l<3 (njjLj lijJ^Aju^o'Jjj^jjltj iS^JUOjJypj Jr?jjlliyy ^yU4*,d]UiiJjX^u^ similar fate awaits the disbelievers. 1+L Is} iVerily, He is All- Strong, Severe in punishment means. He is possessed of great strength and might. ijl} 4Severe in punishment,} means, His punishment is severe and agonizing; we seek refuge with Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, from that. Lja.Alj i\$*J* liy JLSJj^ 4 IW jUIj ijliS j£*j ^>yii £& ^ 5^0 i^=. lij *i;t4 I££i5 £L I£K ;"G? tfls 6**^ y£Jt ji |^=tij J (j0 r*Ij (>yi x^l>i (Jli> 4. l& 1 gz\$ OJ^* iii y>^ ft; cgoVf js£ } 423. And indeed We sent Musa with Our Aydt, and a manifest authority,} 424. To Fir'awn, Hamdn and Qarun, but they called (him): "A sorcerer, a liar!"} 425. Then, when he brought them the Truth from Us, they said: "Kill with him the sons of those wfw believe and let their women live;" but the plots of disbelievers are nothing but in

464 Tafstr Ibn Kathir vain!} 426. Fir'awn said: "Leave me to kill Miisa, and let him call his Lord! I fear that he may change your religion, or that he may cause mischief to appear in the land!"} 427. Miisa said: "Verily, I seek refuge in my Lord and your Lord from every arrogant who believes not in the Day of Reckoning!"} The Story ofMusa and Fir'awn Allah consoles His Prophet Muhammad jg for the disbelief of his people and gives him the glad tidings of good consequences and victory in this world and the Hereafter, as happened to Musa bin Imran, peace be upon him, whom Allah sent with clear

proof and definitive evidence. Allah says: 4with Our Kyat, and a manifest authority}. Authority means proof and evidence. jS 4to Fir'awn}, who was the king of the Copts of Egypt. 4Haman} who was his adviser. 4and Qarun} who was the richest trader among the people of his time. 4but they called (him) : "A sorcerer, liar!"} means, they rejected him and thought he was a sorcerer, a madman and an illusionist who was telling lies about having been sent by Allah. This is like the Ayah: ft i** J

465 Surah 40. ChSfir (23 - 27) (Part-24) 4Likewise, no Messenger came to those before them but they said: "A sorcerer or a madman!" Have they transmitted this saying to these? Nay, they are themselves a people transgressing beyond bounds!} (51:52-53) 4^& (4;t ££> iThen, when he brought them the Truth from Us,} means, with definite evidence that Allah had sent him to them, itii p. \p\ : i> 4they said : "Kill with him the sons of those who believe and let their women live;} This was a second command from Fir'awn to kill the males of the Children of Israel. The first command had been as a precaution against the emergence of a man like Musa, or an act intended to humiliate this people or reduce their numbers or both. The second command was for the second reason, to humiliate the people so that they would regard Musa as a bad omen, they said: J p'j iP ft bit C P, J0 os .ji / < *, 4We (Children of Israel) had suffered troubles before you came to us, and since you have come to us." He said: "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you act?"} (7:129). Qatadah said, this was one command sifter another. ci Cj} ibut the plots of disbelievers are nothing but in vain!} means, their schemes and intentions - to reduce the numbers of the Children of Israel lest they prevail over them - were doomed to failure. 4>*y {pJ P&-i ftj^ (i) At-Tabari 21 :373.

467 Surah 40. Ghdfir (28 - 29) (Part-24) It was reported in the Hadith narrated from Abu MOsa, may Allah be pleased with him, that when the Messenger of Allah Sg was afraid of some people, he would say: «0 Allah, we seek refuge in You from their evil and we seek Your help in repulsing them . (1 ' aui ^ i i Jjii O' jjsj CLsytt i>j Ojy (_p-j JuJy ifii —* (it oj de ^- ^ fjf\ itfilt £3 ZjZ ji^^ v £T %\ pfe 4' 4 £^ j3Cj X* jjLA.\$ list o| o-t 4*^ «jyVf 4 4-tl £4 tij 42S. And a believing tnan of Fir'awn's family, who hid his Faith said: "Would you kill a man because he says: 'My Lord is Allah,' and he has come to you with clear signs from your Lord? And if he is a liar, upon him will be (the sin of) his lie; but if he is telling the truth, then some of that (calamity) wherewith he threatens you will befall on you." Verily, Allah guides not one who is a transgressor, a liar!} 429. "O my people! Yours is the kingdom today, you being dominant in the land. But who will save us from the torment of Allah, should it befall us?" Fir'awn said: "I show you only that which I see, and I guide you only to the path of right policy!"} Musa was supported by a believing Man from Fir'awn's Family The well-known view is that this believing man was a Coptic (Egyptian) from the family of Fir'awn. As-Suddi said, he was a cousin [son of the paternal uncle] of Fir'awn. And it was said that he was the one who was saved along with MQsa, peace be upon him.*2 ' Ibn Jurayj reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said "No one from among the family of An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :188 At-Tabari 21 :375.

iand he has come to you zoith clear signs from your Lord?) means, "how can you kill a man just because he says, 'My Lord is Allah,' and he brings proof that what he is saying is the truth?" Then, for the sake of argument, he went along with them and said, 4And if he is a liar, upon him will be (the sin of) his lie; but if he is telling the truth, then some of that (calamity) wherewith he threatens you will befall on you.) meaning, 'if you do not believe in what he is saying, then it is only common sense to leave him alone

and not harm him; if he is lying, then Allah will punish him for his lies in this world and in the Hereafter. If he is telling the truth and you harm him, then some of what he is warning about will happen to you too, because he is threatening you with punishment in this world and in the Hereafter if you go against him. It is possible that he is telling the truth in your case, so you should leave him and his people alone, and not harm them.' Allah tells us that Musa asked Fir'awn and his people to leave them in peace, as Allah says: JW 41 o' Jy fj J dy. Ctj*' yIU-) ^ o\j 4 l>-v i ojj 4And indeed We tried before them Fir'awn's people, when there came to them a noble Messenger, saying: "Deliver to me the servants of Allah. Verily, I am to you a Messenger worthy of all trust. And exalt not yourselves against Allah. Tndy, I have come to you with a manifest authority. And truly, I seek refuge with my Lord and your Lord, lest you should stone me. But if you believe me not, then keep away from me and leave me alone.") {44:17-21). Similarly, the Messenger of Allah told the Quraysh to leave him alone and let him call the servants of Allah to Allah; he asked them not to harm him, and to uphold the ties of

kinship that existed between him and them, by not harming him. Allah says: 4 40& 'V 4Say: "No reward do I ask ofyou for this except to be kind to mefor my kinship with you."} (42:23), meaning, 'do not harm me, because of the ties of kinship that exist between me and you; so do not harm me, and let me address my ceill to the people.' This was the basis of the truce agreed upon on the day of Al-Hudaybiyah, which was a manifest victory. ji£ & l\} iVerily, Allah guides not one who is a transgressor, a liar!} means, If the one who claims to have been sent by Allah is a liar, as you say, this would be obvious to everyone from his words and deeds, for they would be inconsistent and self- contradictory. But we can see that this man is upright and what he says is consistent. If he was a sinner and a liar, Allah would not have guided him and made his words and actions rational and consistent as you see them.' Then this believer warned his people that they would lose the blessings Allah bestowed upon them and that the vengeance of Allah would befall them: 40 my people! Yours is the kingdom today, you being dominant in the land.} means, 'Allah has blessed you with this kingdom, dominance in the land, power and authority, so take care of this blessing by giving thanks to Allah and believing in his Messenger, and beware of the punishment of All&h if you reject His Messenger.' 4But who will save us from the torment of Allah, should it befall us?} means, these soldiers and troops will not avail you anything and will not ward off the punishment of Allah, if He decides to

471Surah 40. Ghafr (28 - 29) (Part-24) punish us.' Fir'awn said to his people, in response to the advice of this righteous man who was more deserving of kingship than Fir'awn: 41 show you only that which I see,) meaning, *1 only tell you and advise you to do that which I think is good for myself, too.' But Fir'awn lied, because he knew that Mtlsa was telling the truth concerning the Message which he brought. 3#\$ Z3X 4[Musa] said: "Verily, you know that these signs have been sent down by none but the Lord of the heavens and the earth.") (17:102) (lit 4And they belied them (those Ayat) wrongfully and arrogantly, though they were themselves convinced thereof) (27:14) 1 j&j Z) 41 show you only that which I see,) - Fir'awn uttered a lie and a fabrication; he betrayed Allah and His Messenger, and cheated his people by not advising them sincerely. ^ Kj) 4and I guide you only to the path of right policy!) means, 'and I am only calling you to the path of truth, sincerity and guidance.' This was also a lie, but his people obeyed him and followed him. Allah says: 4they followed the command of Fir'awn, and the command of Fir'awn was no right guide) (11:97). ly jOj» oyj> ±J>j) 4And Fir'awn led his people astray, and he did not guide them.) (20:79) According to a Hadith.

473 Surah 40. Ghafir (30 - 35) (Part-24) and those who came after them . And Allah wills no injustice for (His) servants." } 432. "And, O my people! Verily, I fear for you the Day when there will be mutual calling." } 433. A Day when you will turn your backs and flee having no protector from Allah . And whomsoever Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide. } 434. And indeed Yusuf did come to you, in times gone by, with clear signs, but you ceased not to doubt in that which he did bring to you, till when he died, you said: "No Messenger will Allah send after him." Thus Allah leaves astray him who is a transgressor and a skeptic. } 435. Those who dispute about the Ayat of Allah, without any authority that has come to them, it is greatly hateful and disgusting to Allah and to those who believe. Thus does Allah seal up the heart of every arrogant, tyrant. } Here Allah tells us that this righteous man, the believer from among the family of Fir'awn, warned his people of the punishment of Allah in this world and the Hereafter, saying, <O my people! Verily, I fear for you an end like that day (of disaster) of the groups (of old)! } meaning, those of the earlier nations who disbelieved the Messengers of Allah, such as the people of Nuh, 'Ad, Thamud and the disbelieving nations who came after them, how the punishment of Allah came upon them and they had no one to protect them or ward off that punishment. 4iQ. tii lit £j } 4And Allah wills no injustice for (His) servants. } means, Allah destroyed them for their sins and for their disbelief in and rejection of His Messengers; this was His command and His decree concerning them that was fulfilled. Then he said: sjl£ } 4And, O my people! Verily, I fear for you the Day when there

will be mutual calling. } meaning, the Day of Resurrection. 4ty* i>Jy (yfr {A Day when you will turn your backs and flee } means, running away. &. 4> ji {No! There is no refuge! Unto your Lord will be the place of rest that Day. } (75:11-12) Allah says: 4^ in\$ in & {having no protector from Allah. } meaning, "you will have no one to protect you from the punishment and torment of Allah." 4f* in Ji ZX yj } {And whomsoever Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide. } means, whomever Allah sends astray will have no other guide except Him. Allah's saying: jjy <-*~y. jO&j } {And indeed Yusuf came to you, in times gone by, with clear signs, } refers to the people of Egypt. Allah sent a Messenger to them before the time of Musa, peace be upon him, in the person of Yusuf, peace be upon him, who attained a high position in the government of the people of Egypt. He was a Messenger who called his people to Allah with justice, but they did not obey him in matters of worshipping Allah, they only obeyed him in worldly matters that pertained to his position in the government. Allah says: % 'H i\$ 0 4%Lj {but you ceased not to doubt in that which he brought to you, till when he died, you said: "No Messenger will Allah send

475 Surah 40. GhaRr (30 - 35) (Part-24 after him." } means, you despaired, and said by way of wishful thinking, ' 40S it iif J } 4No Messenger will Allah send after him. } This was because of their disbelief and rejection (of the Messengers). cy iil S4> !&&= } 477ms Allah leaves astray him who is a transgressor and a skeptic. } means, this is the state of the one whom Allah sends astray because of his sinful actions and the doubts in his heart. iThose who dispute about the Aydt of Allah, without any authority that has come to them, } means, those who attempt to refute truth with falsehood and who dispute the proof without evidence or proof from Allah, Allah will hate them with the utmost loathing. Allah says: 4[£**' vfM i-ej jif xe lliu 0-=* } iit is greatly hateful and disgusting to Allah and to those who believe. } meaning, the believers too will despise those who are like this, and whoever is like this, Allah will put a seal on his heart so that after that he will not acknowledge anything good or denounce

anything evil. Allah says: *igz y£^ 10} iThus does Allah seal up the heart of every arrogant.*} meaning, so that they cannot follow the truth. <0} 4tyrant.} ft p &S 4\$ MS}

and the plot of Fir'awn led to nothing but loss and destruction.} Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid said, "Meaning nothing but ruin." >Xa |U=»jjS j>ji-il csjf Jlij} i s&.XQzj-zz % & U*®% £% Sj£jf «±ULljti _>4> _^=i ^ '*4£" d** 0*>. Wbj Tttvv'—9- -A" Vd <3S. And the man who believed said: "O my people! Follow me, I will guide you to the way of right conduct."} 439. "O my people! Truly, this life of the world is nothing but an enjoyment, and verily, the Hereafter that is the home that will remain forever."} 440. "Whoever does an evil deed, will not be requited except the like thereof; and whosoever does a righteous deed, whether male or female and is a true believer, such will enter Paradise, where they will be provided therein without limit."} More of what the Believer from Fir'awn's Family said This believer said to his people who persisted in their rebellion and transgression, and preferred the life of this world: <0 my people! Follow me, I will guide you to the way of right conduct.} This is in contrast to the false claim of Fir'awn: 4and I guide you only to the path of right policy.} Then he sought to make them shun this world which they preferred to the Hereafter, and which had prevented them from believing in the Messenger of Allah, Musa, peace be upon him. He said: «££C% j£J» ,j£ C\ ,1J At-Tabari 21 :388.

^ ti&rn ivt (j-aJ La -ilj~>) ;CULJ“^ jlSlI s/rd Cj|Sj^i\yyfj>i\J^==‘y\$^L’J»%^<J (J^15J^c7{f}) (^=0J_>afcc^j^xLiLi^ oliliitijjjs |1j j\B I cjlJbJl 0^<J^jl^ U lj v^’jjg-Urlj jjj| «_jJuJijulil<^>^3iJI(i Tafefr IbtI Kathfr 40 my people! Truly, this life of the world is nothing but an enjoyment,} meaning, it is insignificant and fleeting, and soon it will diminish and pass away. ifjZti%& £4® iand verily, the Hereafter that is the home that will remain forever.} means, the abode which will never end and from which there will be no departure, which will be either Paradise or Hell. Allah says: Z&k J-s-c iWhosoever does an evil deed, will not be requited except the like thereof;} means, one like it. SyCu. CjjjSiji <iUlj1i » i> ' \$ i ext && }and whosoever does a righteous deed, whether male or female and is a true believer, such will enter Paradise, where they will be provided therein without limit.} means, the reward cannot be enumerated, but Allah will give an immense reward without end. And Allah is the Guide to the straight path. 4/4> u>he'-Z \ 4 C iy&f}

-Vr V lA) ^6 <-> o-4 1* -4i vi>«^ |*J» if 4A J'k lij,* ol> inj-Sf' 4 'ij CjJ)' tj iyj /) u'jC_JU Silt ill' ,£\$^1 f&e*i jjS U JxJdlilj fi|>jLjlt IflL- jUJt 0 ?^*-ttijjt ftji- J±J •~» - La 411I JLlJ J* lct£)l jtjSJ pj j iLitj 1}ji "And O my people! How is it that I call you to salvation while you call me to the Fire!"} 442. "You invite me to disbelieve in Allah, and to join partners in worship with Him of which I have no knowledge; and I invite you to the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving!"} 443 . "La Jarama, you call me to one that does not have a claim in this world or in the Hereafter. And our return will be to Allah, and the transgressors, they shall be the dwellers of the Fire!"} 444. "And you will remember what I am telling you, and my affair I leave it to Allah. Verily, Allah is the All-Seer of (His) servants."} 445. So, Allah saved him from the evils that they plotted (against him), while an evil torment encompassed Fir'awn's people.} 446. The Fire, they are exposed to it, morning and afternoon. And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels) : "Admit Fir'awn's people into the severest torment!"} The Conclusion of the Believer's Words, and the ultimate Destiny of both Parties That believer said: "Why do I call you to salvation, which is the worship of Allah alone with no partner or associate, and

belief in His Messenger, whom He has sent,' 4% .* 4 J3 u it 1. 4while you call me to the Fire! You invite me to disbelieve in Allah, and to join partners in worship with Him of which 1 have no knowledge;}

480 Tafslr Ibn Kathir means, on the basis of ignorance, with no proof or evidence. iand I invite you to the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving!} means, with all His might and pride, He still forgives the sin of the one who repents to Him. i4i Xfy* C3 4La Jarama, you call me to one} They say it means, "Truly." As-Suddi and Ibn Jarir said that the meaning of His saying: 4La jarama} means "Truly." Ad-Dahhak said: <Vr I} 4Ld jarama} means, "No lie." 'Ali bin Abi Talhah and Ibn 'Abbas said: 4Ld Jarama} means, "Indeed, the one that you call me to of idols and false gods 4 'ij Oj)* 4 4that does not have a claim in this world or in the Hereafter}." Mujahid said, "The idols that do not have anything. "• 1 Qatadah said, "This means that idols possess no power either to benefit or to harm." As-Suddi said, "They do not respond to those who call upon them, either in this world or in the Hereafter."121 This is like the Ayah: Cf (v»j SJt J1 V j* oji i —"A y*j} }And ivho is more astray than one who calls on besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and ivho are unaware of their calls to them? And when the people are gathered, they will become their enemies and deny their At-Jabari 21 :392. 121 At-Jabari 21 :392.

481Surah 40. Ghdfir (41 - 46) (Part-24) worship> (46:5-6) 4\$ C \yLC? V yys, o) 4lfyou invoke them, they hear not your call; and if they were to hear, they could not grant it to you) (35:14). 4And our return will be to Allah,) means, in the Hereafter, where He will reward or punish each person according to his deeds. He says: iand the transgressors, they shall be the divellers of the Fire!) meaning, they will dwell therein forever, because of their great sin, which is associating others in worship with Allah. jji^ £ oxjfcLi) 4And you ivill remember what I am telling you,) means, V°u will come to know the truth of what 1 enjoined upon "you and forbade you to do, the advice I gave you and what I explained to you. You will come to know, and you will feel regret at the time when regret will be of no avail.' 4and my affair I leave it to Allah.) means, 1 put my trust in Allah and seek His help, and I renounce you utterly.' & d>) 4Verily, Allah is the All-Seer of(His) servants.) means, He knows all about them, may He be exalted and sanctified, and He guides those who deserve to be guided and sends astray those who deserve to be sent astray; His is the perfect proof, utmost wisdom and mighty power. 4So Allah saved himfrom the evils that they plotted,) means, in this world and in the Hereafter; in this world, Allah saved him along with Musa, peace be upon him, and in the Hereafter (He will admit him) to Paradise.

Proofofthe Torment ofthe Grave iwhile an evil torment encompassed Fir'awn's people. this refers to drowning in the sea, then being transferred from there to Hell, for their souls are exposed to the Fire morning and evening until the Hour begins. When the Day of Resurrection comes, their souls and bodies will be reunited in Hell. Allah says: At) ^Ajyy itUji pil 4And on the Dap when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Admit Fir'awn's people to the severest torment!"} meaning, more intense pain and greater agony. This Ayah contains one of the major proofs used by the Ahlus-Sunnah to prove that there will be torment in the grave during the period of Al-Barzakh; it is the phrase: \$\\Axc-j Vjic iThe Fire, they are exposed to it, morning and afternoon}. But the question arises: this Ayah was undoubtedly revealed in Makkah, but they use it as evidence to prove that there will be torment in the grave during the period of Al-Barzakh) l] Imam Ahmad recorded from 'A'ishah, may

Allah be pleased with her, that a Jewish woman used to serve her, and whenever ‘A’ishah did her a favor, the Jewish woman would say, “May Allah save you from the torment of the grave.” ‘A’ishah said, “Then the Messenger of Allah came in, and I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, will there be any torment in the grave before the Day of Resurrection?’ He said, “No, no one said that?” I said, This Jewish woman, whenever I do her a favor, she says: May Allah save you from the torment of the grave.” The Messenger of Allah said, * The life after death, before the Day of Resurrection

“The Jews are lying, and they tell more lies about Allah. There is no torment except on the Day of Resurrection .» Then as much time passed as Allah willed should pass, then one day he came out at midday, wrapped in his robe with his eyes reddening, calling at the top of his voice: u bfrSi; i \$ k(akiii jiii jbuf Eii« «The grave is like patches of dark night! O people, if you knew what I know, you would weep much and laugh little. O people, seek refuge with Allah from the torment of the grave, for the torment of the grave is real”[1] This chain of narration is Sahih according to the conditions of Al-Bukhari and Muslim, although they did not record it. It was said, ‘how can this report be reconciled with the fact that the Ayah was revealed in Makkah and the Ayah indicates that there will be torment during the period of Al-Barzakh?’ The answer is that the Ayah refers to the souls (of Fir’awn and his people) being exposed to the Fire morning and evening; it does not say that the pain will affect their bodies in the grave. So it may be that this has to do specifically with their souls. With regard to there being any effect on their bodies in Al-Barzakh, and their feeling pain as a result, this is indicated in the Sunnah, in some Hadiths which we will mention below. It was said that this Ayah refers to the punishment of the disbelievers in Al-Barzakh, and that it does not by itself imply that the believer will be punished in the grave for his sins. This is indicated by the Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, according to which the Messenger of Allah entered upon ‘A’ishah when a Jewish woman was with her, and she (the Jewish woman) was saying, “I was told that you will be tried in the grave.” The Messenger of Allah was worried and said: «O Jews will be tested.» ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, “Several nights [•I Ahmad 6 :81

661 Z- t> uinsriiAl ‘ 98S : £MPSIVMW [z] V XVZ peuiqv | t) Jo (sp8uv) ssadaaq dip o] dvs pirn auij at// ui ssotp puy 'Qff 4"jS}UVOi9S (S!H) U33(ti)3q pd8pn(sot/ ijvpy 'djU3/[i(duij) sup ui (j3ip38o)) \ \v 3uv 3foj(i : dvs pirn }uv8onv 3U3ai oi{m. ssoin -gp} i,i3U}d 3t0 J° uopjod 3iuos sn uiojJ sqv; imp nod two 'no/i psmopoj3m 'd}U3/[fi :)uv8onv sism otjm 3S0ip o/ dv pirn qvom sip '3uij sip in apidsip pirn dsip usqm 'puy ypf s»jfi zvfi r? ig. v r.f\ Cttf'zrc*? 5>£ rtf& ft Cttt ifert rtf ip? 'r ip r-frf ^ X? f?c \$ '? ^ ^V r sr fip?x\$&f\ jc jfc? PWj \$ C^ p ?tr J?T r?y^! Ip jtrvo^r p-^<? r irr ' i fi |Cr«W*^ OAM 3M1 ui ~ _r JV' _ A, * ^payodai ospj sbm ij ^ t^T Pr5 -Tp'IPpr Il |« 8 'UOpsouunSSH fife==^1rCf'i r fT”^ fffh me—V“frr^C-rvinv /o /i»a xp UO }l 0) 08 ' " 5- pi' M4 0i nod SP3UUHS3U ijvpy 1^5? c^J^r9^JJ=^7Cp^ 33V]d mod St Slip Cr^,rr^Cr^^C,mrfaTrrr^^P 'i/i/i/ 0) pws sq pirn u 'Y \ -T 1PH 1° 3ldosd sip jo duo s, sq imp 'IPH fo sjdosd sip Jo duo si dif Ji puv ^ s "" **<*” ""k -s's,<\ A" 'dsipvuvj Jo 3\dodd 3ip Jo v^.'f a«o s/ sq imp 'ssipvuvj ^ JXrf^f.nfiJo 3\do3d 3ip Jo 3uo si sq ' X \~\;y ;' <- ^)!•"- , v 'I Ji '.8uiu303 puv 8unuoiu iffiKSIPfe aa; x? (OS -ZWW ID 'Of WVS

486 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Hell : “Call upon your Lord to lighten for us the torment for a day!”} i5Q . They xvill say: "Did there not come to you, your Messengers with (clear) evidences?" They will say: "Yes." They loill reply : "Then call (as you like)! And the invocation of the disbelievers is nothing but in

vain!"} The Dispute of the People of Hell Allah tells us how the people of Hell will dispute and argue with one another, and Fir'awn and his people will be among them. The weak, who were the followers, will say to those who were arrogant, who were the leaders and masters: id e.» iVerily, we followed you,} meaning, 'We obeyed you and heeded your call to disbelief and misguidance in the world,' i can you then take from us some portion of the Fire?} means, 'can you carry a part of our burden for us?' id "fq &} iTlwsc who were arrogant will say: "We are all (together) in this (Fire)!..."} meaning, "we will not bear any part of your burden for you; our own punishment is enough for us to bear." idS &dA) iVerily, Allah has judged (His) servants!} means, 'He has shared out the punishment among us according to what each of us deserves'. This is like the Ayah: iff %£& < p iHe xvill say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you knv not."} (7:38) iAnd those in the Fire xvill say to the keepers (angels) of Hell "Call upon your Lord to lighten for us the torment for a day!"}

487 Surah 40. Ghafir (47-50) (Part-24) They know that Allah will not answer them and will not listen to their prayer, because He said, 4>v 'jj Ljj iRemain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!} (23:108), so they will ask the keepers of Hell, who are like jailers watching over the people of Hell, to pray to Allah to lessen the Fire for them if only for one day. But the keepers of Hell will refuse, saying to them, J*0 *>*,>> £•" f" > * \ 4Did there not come to you, your Messengers with (clear) evidences? \$ meaning, was not proof established in the world on the lips of the Messengers? iThey will say: "Yes." They will reply: "Then call (as you like)!..."} means, you are on your own. We will not pray for you or listen to you; we do not want you to be saved and we have nothing to do with you. Moreover, we tell you that it is all the same whether you offer supplication or not, because Allah will not respond and He will not lighten the torment for you.' They will say: 4 v) 4^3'& i:'} 4And the invocation of the disbelievers is nothing but in vain!} meaning, it will not be accepted or responded to. -Vi jyj Cal' jjli' 4 [£**• OHj JCJ Of} Cijj Cul* 1' *>-» fi-flj YLO.Uf | OjU-Lli tj ojx* Si ^ rCi % 4-mil* Li -A^>=» 6]

488 Tafsir Ibn Kalbir 451. Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth, 452. The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers. Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode. 453. And, indeed We gave Musa the guidance, and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit the Scripture -> 454. A guide and a reminder for men of understanding 455. So be patient. Verily, the promise of Allah is true, and ask forgiveness for your fault, and glorify the praises of your Lord in the 'Ashl and in the Ibkar.} 456. Verily, those who dispute about the Ayat of Allah, without any authority having come to them, there is nothing else in their breasts except pride. They will never have it. So seek refuge in Allah. Verily, it is He Who is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer> The Victory of the Messengers and the Believers 4 CILj 4Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life As-Suddi, "Allah never sends a Messenger to a people and they kill him or some of the believers who call them to the truth, then that generation passes away, but He then sends them someone who will support their call and will seek vengeance for their blood from those who did that to them in this world. So the Prophets and believers may be killed in this world, but their call will prevail in this world." Allah granted victory to His Prophet Muhammad sg and his Companions over those who had opposed him, disbelieved in him and shown hostility towards him. He caused His Word and His religion to prevail over all other religions, commanded him to emigrate from his people to Al-Madinah, where He gave him supporters and helpers. Then He caused him to prevail in At-Jabari 21 :401.

489 Surah 40. Ghafir (51 - 56) (Part-24) over the idolators on the day of Badr, when He granted him victory over them and he humiliated them, killing their leaders and taking their elite prisoner, driving them before him in chains. Then he did them the favor of accepting ransom from them. Shortly after that, Allah enabled him to conquer Makkah, and he rejoiced in his return to his homeland, the sacred and holy land of Al-Haram. Through him, Allah saved it from its disbelief and Shirk. Then Allah enabled him to conquer the Yemen, and the entire Arabian Peninsula submitted to him, and the people entered the religion of Allah in crowds. Then Allah took him (in death), because of his high status and honor, and He established his Companions as his Khalifahs. They conveyed the religion of Allah from him, called mankind to Allah, they conquered many regions, countries and cities, and opened people's hearts, until the call of Muhammad jg spread throughout the world, east and west. This religion will continue to prevail until the Hour begins. Allah says: i: \$& eif &2J 4 !P iVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will standforth} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection the victory will be greater and more complete. Mujahid said, "The witnesses are the angels." 11 ' ^ pi^ 4The Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers.} is referring to the same as; 4...the Day when the witnesses will standforth.} Others read it with that meaning; m At-Tabari 2 1 :402

490 Tafslr Ibn Katfir iAnd the Day the witnesses will stand forth, is a Day when there will be no profit to wrongdoers. and the wrongdoers are the idolators. itheir excuses means, no excuse or ransom will be accepted from them. itua iTheirs will be the curse,} means, they will be cast out far away from the mercy of Allah. 4and theirs will be the evil abode.} means, the Hell-fire, as As- Suddi said, a terrible abode and dwellingplace. Indication that the Messenger and the Believers will prevailjust asMusaand the Children ofIsrael prevailed itsi4K j-f a: -jZj} 4And, indeed We gave Musa the guidance.} means, the guidance and light with which Allah sent him. iand We caused the Children of Israel to inherit the Scripture.} means, We caused them to prevail in the end and they inherited the land and accumulated wealth of Fir'awn, because of their patience in obeying Allah and following His Messenger Mtisa.' The Scripture which they inherited, the Tawrah, was 4t**VPVf JjV i£jj>} 4A guide and a reminderfor men of understanding.} i.e. those of a sound and upright nature. 4So be patient} means, 'O Muhammad,' 4&- 4»' llj 4Verily, the promise of Allah is true,} means, "We have promised

497 Sural» 40. Ghafir (51 - 56) (Part-24) that your word will prevail and that the ultimate victory will be for you and those who follow you, and Allah does not break His promises. What We have told you is true and there is no doubt in it whatsoever.' iand ask forgiveness for your fault,} This encourages the Ummah to seek forgiveness. Of iand glorify the praises ofyour Lord in the 'Ashi meaning, at the end of the day and the beginning of the night, iand in the Ibkdr.} meaning, at the beginning of the day and the end of the night. iVerily, those who dispute about the Ayat of Allah, zuithout any authority having come to them,} means, they try to refute the truth with falsehood, and to refute sound evidence with dubious arguments, having no proof or evidence from Allah. ithere is nothing else in their breasts except pride. They will never have it.} means, they are too proud to follow the truth and submit to the one who has brought it. But their attempts to suppress the truth and elevate falsehood will fail; the truth will prevail and their words and aspirations will be defeated. x£~l&} iSo seek refuge in Allah.} means, from being like these people, 41*\$y*2At iVerily, it is He Who is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer.} or seek refuge with Him from being like these people who dispute about the Ayat of Allah without any authority having

f V, come to them. %\SA\h\ £j} 0j^iL\x^/\^=4j^j0^>J~&y & ^dif j. v uji^* J^=>1 <^>i/>;lj -W^t> lS^Jj lij
 ^ui i£ii. Sific j^J'S\$ 4#^ U 5U tpi .00 * ^ ^ & he(wens md theJlh ig ^=^yj^/\^S3c£fS^ \ *ndeed greater
 than the >>">s<'5\"uX3 * ^^ <*tf creation of mankind ; ya, most of the people 3\$\$ rfo not know 'a^A
 -f- -* < V- *58 - And not cctlal are ^U^oj^oy-^AJA^o\^o[the blind and those who ^ o1oJ*1j4Joio££ft
 see ' MOr ^osc who be- Keoff, and do righteous good deeds, and those who co evil . Little do you
 remember!} 459. Verily, the Hour is surely coming, there is no doubt about it, yet most men believe
 not.} Life after Death Allah tells us that He will bring back His creation on the Day of Resurrection.
 That is very easy for Him, because He created the heavens and the earth, and creating them is greater
 than creating mankind, the first time and when He creates them again. The One Who is able to do that is
 able to do anything that is less than that. As Allah says: Jf. o' & j-el U uk \$> j&ij o>l!i \$L orii iii %
 Xff,))} 4 17'.5,-k tfy ff ,ii] 2>j djlK

493 Surah 40. Ghdfir (57 - 59) (Part-24) 4Do they not see that Allah, Wlw created the heavens and the
 earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is able to do
 all things.} (46:33) And Allah says here: V u;UJ' J^==^ l&j uj'-il' if jji==3 (JfjV'j oy—l'l' 4The creation
 of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind; yet, most of mankind know
 not.} hence they do not think about or ponder this proof. Similarly, many of the Arabs recognized that
 Allah had created the heavens and the earth, but they denied and rejected the idea of the resurrection;
 they acknowledged something which was greater than that which they denied. Then Allah says: U XJj
 iy4* cd-jj'j \>j} 4And not equal are the blind and those who see; nor are tlwsc who believe, and do
 righteous good deeds, and those wlw do evil . Little do you remember!} The blind man who cannot see
 anything is not the same as the sighted man who can see everything as far as his eyesight reaches - there
 is a huge difference between them. By the same token, the righteous believers and the immoral
 disbelievers are not equal. {Little do you remember'.} means, most of the people remember little. 4%\$
 ielilf 4 Verily, the Hour (Day of Judgement) is surely coming,} means, it will indeed come to pass. V
 J^==^ l&j LfJ v-j {there is no doubt about it, yet most men believe not.} means, they do not believe in
 it, and in fact they doubt its existence altogether.

494 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4->4e o* oi ^3 4-?^ o>*j1 ^=45 H&j} ^60. And your Lord said: "Call upon Me, I
 will answer you. Verily, those who scorn My worship they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!"} The
 Command to call upon Allah By His grace and kindness, Allah encourages His servants to call upon
 Him, and He guarantees to respond. Sufyan Ath- Thawn used to say: "O You Who love most those who
 ask of You, and O You Who hate most those who do not ask of You, and there is no one like that apart
 from You, O Lord." This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Similarly; the poet said: "Allah hates not to
 be asked, and the son of Adam hates to be asked." Qatadah said that Ka*b Al-Ahbar said, "This Ummah
 has been given three things which were not given to any nation before, only to Prophets. When Allah
 sent a Prophet, He said to him, You are a witness over your nation.' But you have been made witnesses
 over mankind; it was said to the Prophets individually, 'Allah has not laid upon you any hardship in
 religion,' but He said to this entire Ummah i>i oyN 4 J44 Cj} 4and [Allah] has not laid upon you in
 religion any hardship (22 :78) and it was said to the Prophets individually; 'Call upon Me, I will answer
 you,' but it was said to this Ummah, 4Call upon Me, I will answer you}." This was recorded by Ibn Abi
 Hatim.' Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Nu'man bin Bashir, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The
 Messenger of Allah said: m Al-Qurtubi 15:327.

495 Surah 40. Ghafir (60) (Part-24) «Indeed the supplication is the worship.*» Then he recited. 4A>id your Lord sou/ : "Call upon Me, I will answer you. Verily, those who scorn My worship they will surely enter Hell in humiliation/".11! This was also recorded by the Sunan compilers; At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, Ibn Majah, and Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahth."*2 * It was also recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, and Ibn Jarir with a different chain of narration .*31 Allah's saying: 4Verily, those who scorn My worship means, "those who are too proud to call on Me and single Me out," 4they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!\$ means, in disgrace and insignificance. Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Amr bin Shu'ayb from his father, from his grandfather that the Prophet jg said: ijlljSfl jU i y. "4 Jli ^ •jiln ja'i iji^Ji ij? ja 'j'jiC <iThe proud will be gathered on the Day of Resurrection like ants in the image of people, and everything will be stepping on them, humiliating than, until they enter a prison in Hell called Biilas. They will be fed flames of fire, and given for drink a paste of insanity dripping from the people the Fire.®"4 jc jJZ jjJ ^ii jJ3i iO J^~i- ifJl iity [2! 13] Ahmad 4 :271 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:308, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:405, Ibn Majah 2:1258, At-Tabari 21 :406, 407 Abu Dawud 1:161, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:121, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :450 Ahmad 1:179.

}Cs~ «3^~ f&j >' 1? ojU' ojlilf ^ t\$R <<>J(^ jg % 4\% v i&sSi f^pj &s« #3 j^Vi jU^ dx & ji ::*: *£sil 4^> tft _fij£2 J4=4J j£jS 4^1 5 J3& 4.,f:~if4A J&il^ *US t#fc3P vi Xdt V <62 . AZ/o/i, it is He Wlw has made the night for you that you may rest therein and the day for you to see. Truly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind; yet, most of mankind give no thanks. i62 . That is Allah, your Lord, the Creator of all things, La ildlta ild Huwa. How then are you turning away?} 463 . Thus were turned away those who used to deny the Aydt of Allah.} 464. Allah, it is He Who has made for you the earth as a dwelling place and the sky as a canopy, and has given you shape and made your slmpes good and pure (looking) and has provided you with good things. That is Allah, your Lord, so Blessed be Allah, the Lord of all tlmt exists.} 465. He is the Ever Living, La ilaha ilia Huwa; so invoke Him making the religion for Him Alone. All the praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.} Signs of the Power and Oneness of Allah Allah reminds us of His grace towards His creation in that He has given them the night in which they rest and relax from their activities so that they can go back to them for their livelihood during the day. He has given them the day with its light, so that they can undertake their journeys and engage in their business. 44l^=CJ "2 u;UJf Jc ^Jai JjJ Sif iTruly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind; yet, most of mankind give no thanks.} means, they do not express gratitude for the favors which Allah bestows upon them. Then Allah says: i%t4 V ^ p,j ill^}

497 Surah 40. Ghafir (61 - 65) (Part-24) 4That is Allah, your Lord, the Creator of all things, La ilaha ilia Huwa.} means, the One Who does all of these things is Allah, the One, the Unique, the Creator of all things, besides Whom there is no other god or lord. 4How then are you turning away?} means, how can you worship idols which cannot create anything but are themselves hand- made and carved?' oijlL ^ iThus were turned away those who used to deny the Aydt of Allah£ means, just as these people (Quraysh) were led astray by their worship of gods other than Allah, those who came before them also disbelieved and worshipped others, with no proof or evidence, but on the basis of ignorance and desires. They denied the signs and proof of Allah. 4Allah, it is He Who has made for you the earth as a dwelling place means, "He made it stable and spread it out for you, so that you might live on it and travel about in it; He strengthened it with the mountains so that it does not shake with you.' 4and the sky as a canopy,\$ means, 'a roof covering and protecting the world.' 4and has given you shape and

made your shapes good} means, 'He created you in the best and most perfect form.' Si fYYY} 4and has provided you with good and pure things .} means, of food and drink in this world. Allah states that that He is the Creator of the dwelling place and of the inhabitants and of the

provision; He is the Creator and Provider, as He says in Surat Al-Baqarah: j3' *-fji' j^3j 'jilt' Sb ffcj 5* - A gfc tu .13' Sj\$ it ;I3(j JoVT 4 " Ij'ijl *i ijLif 40 mankind! Worship your Lord (Allah), Who created you and those who were before you so tlwt you may have Taqwa. Who has made the earth a resting place for you, and the sky as a canopy, and sent down water (rain) from the sky and brought forth therewith fruits as a provision for you . Then do not set up rivals unto Allah while you know.} (2:21-22) And here Allah says, after mentioning the creation of all these things: iodiJ4^ S3 -0JC2JM; S3 iThat is Allah, your Ldrd, so Blessed be Allah, the Lord of all that exists.} meaning, exalted and sanctified and glorified be Allah, the Lord of all the worlds. Then He says: iZ^ 'A V&£ s>¥ 4He is the Ever Living, La ildha ilia Huxva;} means, He is the Ever Living, from eternity to eternity, Who was, is and shall be, the First and the Last, the Manifest, the Hidden. 4Ld ildha ilia Huwa} means, there is none comparable or equal to Him. ikS a 4so invoke Him making the religion for Him Alone.} means, affirm His Oneness by testifying that there is no God but He. Praise be to Allah, the Lord of the worlds. Imam Ahmad recorded that after ending every prayer, 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr used to say: ^ J* 'j* j*j tiuii a) JiUit a .a i ^ sjj

499Surah 40. Ghafir (65 - 68) (Part-24, aJi v i«i)L Vi a*j Vj tf ailSl VI JLL Vj a Jill VI alljl aJj aJj aLJI iii vi Lit V > a jij J^ajJl a] ' . ."> 1 ->. «3j^i£ii (There is no (true) God except Allah Alone with no partner or associate, to Him belongs the do- minion and praise, for He is able to do all things; there is no strength and no power except with Allah; there is no (true) God except Allah and we worship none but Him; to Him belong blessings and vir- tue and goodly praise; there is no (true) God except Allah, we zoorship Him in all sincerity even though the disbelievers may hate that. He said, "The Messenger of Allah jg used to say the Tahiti in this fashion after every prayer."111 Similar was also recorded by Muslim, Abu Dawud and An-Nasal.121 3 tjj at oLLjl ID ajif pja at \$ •* - f fJdt. St f a; p y! / at cjjjl J* 'L'LLiJ' cf) j^Lii 5? * os \}JZi 13^ <&, Of0&% 2~£ <4* > S '4 JjSJ 111 Ahmad 4 :4. 121 Muslim 1 : 415 and 416, Abu Dawud 2 :173, An-Nasal 3 :79, 80.

500 Tafsxr Ibn Kathir 466. Say: "I have been forbidden to worship those whom you worship besides Allah, since there have come to me evidences from my Lord; and I am commanded to submit to tire Lord of all that exists. 467. It is He, Who has created you from dust, then from a Nutfah then from a clot (a piece of coagulated blood), then brings you forth as an infant, then (makes you grow) to reach the age offull strength, and afterwards to be old - though some among you die before - and that you reach an appointed term in order that you may understand> 468. It is He Who gives life and causes death. And when He decides upon a thing He says to it only: "Be!" - and it is.) The Prohibition ofShirk, the Order for Tawhid, andthe Evidence Allah says, 'say, O Muhammad, to these idolaters, that Allah forbids them to worship anyone, such as these idols and false gods, except Him.' Allah explains that no one apart from Him is deserving of worship, as He says: rfjSf Z) VJZi 4It is He, Who fvis created you from dust, then from a Nutfah then from a clot (a piece of coagulated blood), then brings you forth as an infant, then (makes you grow) to reach the age of full strength, and afterwards to be old.) meaning, He is the OneWho Alone, with no partner or associate, causes you to pass through these different stages, and this happens in accordance with His command, will and decree. 4though some among you

die before) means, before being fully formed and emerging to this world; so his mother miscarries him. And there are some who die in infancy or in their youth, or when they are adults but before they reach old age, as Allah says: 4tixat We may make (it) clear to you. And We cause whom We

502 Surah 40. Ghafir (69 - 76) (Part-24) will to remain in the wombs for an appointed term} (22:5). and that you reach an appointed term in order that you may understand.} Ibn Jurayj said, "In order that you may remember the Resurrection." Then Allah says: # v4< ilt is He Who gives life and causes death.} meaning, He is the Only One Who does that, and none is able to do that except He. S 'A #. 1#\$ ZsA 4And when He decides upon a thing He says to it only: "Be!" - and it is.} means, He cannot be opposed or resisted. Whatever He wills definitely comes to pass. tly \sP=x> CtJ' U OjLifi ifM jI J5 ffi} 4 '0 <j> : >>--2 d--l .dtj Q JJiV' jt \Sy—i lAij .a, liLy P o/> X P' 42*# Hj #> <S#J' ii' ££ ^ \)JS i^ij o'P~ (*-«* -# 'p' Cjpp jKiu Jffii iljy-Ju jff i> i/Ju i69. See you not those who dispute about the Aydt of Allah? Hoio are they turning away?} 470. Those ivho detiy the Book, and that with which We sent Our Messengers they will come to know.} 471. When iron collars will be rounded over their necks, and the chains, they shall be dragged along,} 472. In the boiling water, then they will be burned in the Fire.} 473. Then it ivill be said to them: "Where are (all) those whom you used to consider partners"} 474. "Besides Allah"? They will say: "They have vanished from us. Nay, we did not call upon anything before." Thus

503 Surah 40. Ghafir (69 - 76) (Part-24) between it and the fierce boiling water!} (55:43-44). After describing how they will eat Zaqqum (a bitter tree of Hell) and drink Hamim (boiling water), Allah says: 3? (H-*^ 0) ft iThen thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell.} (37:68), And Allah says: M v Jt 'ft fjr j jr^i i&h Z jCiJl itkeif 4And those on the Left Hand - how (unfortunate) will be those on the Left Hand? In fierce hot wind and boiling water, and shadow of black smoke, (that shadow) neither cool nor (even) pleasant.} until ^r* <*40 a x&J' ojJUJi \$ js} 41*10 ft. < 4?& ftfr- && iThen moreover, verily, - you the erring-ones, the deniers (of Resurrection)! You verily, will eat of the trees of Zaqqum . Then you will fill your bellies therewith, and drink boiling water on top of it. And you will drink (that) like thirsty camels! That will be their entertainment on the Day of Recompense'} (56:41-44, 51-56), " r & flit' cfl- v_>Uc j* *ir?L 3j 'f ,»Y, Jp ifcJb ftji. 'tY . pf 'ft U U£ ul S.jrft==tJ\ Jppjfi ji iVerily, the tree of Zaqqum will be the food of the sinners. Like boiling oil, it will boil in the bellies, like the boiling of scalding ivater. (It will be said:) "Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire, then pour over his head the torment of boiling water . Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous! Verily, this is that whereof you used to doubt!"} (44:43-50) i.e., this will be said to them to rebuke and ridicule them.

504 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Pjj ot X<S&£ ft 4Then it will be said to them : "Wfxere are (all) those whom you considered partners - besides Allah?"} means, it will be said to them, "where are the idols whom you used to worship instead of Allah? Can they help you today?" |p— }They will say: "They have vanished from us..."} mean, they have gone away and they cannot do anything for us.' jp at !££ 4Nay, we did not invoke (worship) anything before.} means, they will deny that they worshipped them. This is like the Ayah if i>' J% JS p 2} iThere will then be (left) no Fitnah (excuse) for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."} (6:23) Allah says: J' j-j* ^ iThus Allah leads astray the disbelievers}. i 5^' 4That was because you had been exulting in the earth without any right, and that you used to rejoice extremely.} means, the angels will say to them, "what

you are suffering now is your recompense for your exulting in the earth without any right, and for your extravagance.' JPj tj-i OyU>- 'jlio' 4Enter the gates of Hell to abide therein, and (indeed) what an evil abode of the arrogant!} means, what a terrible abode and final destination, filled with humiliation and severe punishment for those who arrogantly ignored the signs of Allah and refused to accept His proof and evidence. And Allah knows best.

505Surah 40. Ghdfir (77 - 78) (Part-24) JL_&> 0^ ^ ij3*? diL^i &)Ji J^U* Cyi bJL-ij^ JjJj p^ «5J wXlif- l .»4^4> ^ >4*5 d& Uj CdAlU ^ & &i% Ot J <!)' ^*1 *l^>- 'it Ail' ^illlLa J^>-_> Si-^} 4 vvS^lklj' 477. So be patient, verily, the promise of Allah is true and whether We show you some part of what We have promised them, or We cause you to die, then still it is to Us they all shall be returned.} 478. And, indeed We have sent Messengers before you, of some of them We have related to you their story. And of some We have not related to you their story, and it was not given to any Messenger that he should bring a sign except by the leave of Allah. But, tohen comes the commandment of Allah, the matter xoill be decided with truth, and the followers of falsehood xoill then be lost.} The Command to be Patient and Good News of Victory Here Allah commands His Messenger to patiently bear the rejection of those who rejected him: 'Allah will fulfill His promise to you that you will be victorious and will prevail over your people, and you and those who follow you, will be the successful ones in this world and the Hereafter.' J tvi jjJj djfc.ol (JA 4JJ jli4ii^oilj'i/JSjliJ JCdiHj\y>zfb ^ f»4^ ^ LUi ojt-J-r-A ly 1irt 0 j Jk<j3\ff\

and whether We show you some part of what We have promised them,} means, in this world, and this is what happened, for Allah gave them the joy of humiliating the leaders and nobles (of the Quraysh), who were killed on the day of Badr, then Allah granted them victory over Makkah and the entire Arabian Peninsula during the lifetime of the Prophet sg. 4or We cause you to die, then still it is to Us they all shall be returned.} means, 'and We shall inflict a severe punishment upon them in the Hereafter.' Then Allah says, consoling [His Prophet jg): i^liA o* 02 4And, indeed We have sent Messengers before you, of some of them We have related to you their story.} as Allah also says in Surat An-NisaV ' meaning, "We have revealed the stories of some of them and how their people disbelieved in them, but the Messengers ultimately prevailed.' 4And of some We have not related to you their story,} and they are many, many more than those whose stories have been told, as has been stated in Surat An-Nisa'. Praise and blessings be to Allah. ^A Ojlt^ AjtIJ J JAA dfc and it was not given to any Messenger that he should bring a sign except by the leave of Allah.} means, none of the Prophets was able to bring miracles to his people except when Allah granted him permission to do that as a sign of the truth of the message he brought to them. 4But, when comes the commandment of Allah,} means, His punishment and vengeance which will encompass m See volume three , the Tafsir of Surat An-Nisa' (4 :164)

507Siirah 40. Ghdfir (79 - 81) fPart-24) the disbelievers, 4the matter will be decided with truth,} so the believers will be saved and the disbelievers will be destroyed. Allah says: and the followers of falsehood will then be lost.} 'If + >.s * - .Mtr </-> •> >> . {"/ 'f' A* __ > i Jfj ijl A*-U- Ljlb / . -r I^ *1 479. AZ/a/ i, if is He W7io iws made cattle for you, that you may ride on some of them, and of some you eat.} 480. And you have (many other) benefits from them, and that you may reach by their means a desire that is in your breasts, and on them and on ships you are carried.} 481. And He shows you His Ayat. Which, that of the Ayat of Allah do you deny?} The Cattle are also a Blessing from Allah and a Sign from Him

Allah reminds His servants of His blessing in that He created the cattle \Al-An'am\ for them, which refers to camels, cows and sheep; some of them they ride and some of them they eat. Camels may be ridden or eaten; their milk is drunk and they are used for carrying heavy burdens on journeys to distant lands. Cattle are eaten and their milk is drunk; they are also used for plowing the earth. Sheep are eaten and their milk is also drunk. The hair and wool of all of these animals is used to make tents, clothing and furnishings, as we have already discussed in Surat Al-An'am and Surat An-Nahl,^ 1 ^ etc. Allah says here: kSrf p; i£5 flup 4 Sil> y4^-',?•*»? \S <" "K >> . ,<•' m See (6 : 142) and (16 :58 , 66 , 80)

4Allah, it is He Who has made cattle for you, that you may ride on some of than, and of some you eat. And you have (many other) benefits from them, and that you may reach by their means a desire that is in your breasts, and on them and on ships you are carried.} 4*4^ ; Jssujj,} 4And He shows you His Aydt.} means, 'His proof and evidence, on the horizons and in yourselves. iWhich, then of the Aydt ofAllah do you deny?} means, you cannot deny any of His signs and proofs, unless you are stubborn and arrogant. _a£==>1 ijilT (Vftj at d 4 jihfy (vjlij ££ . \y(> U ffC- Hi 1 4 SjHCj yi -Lijj ill) His jjikT U j*4j ,JLll 01 Uj oiiLllj & \$ W4r^ -H% <*t }%>& &£ £-t 4 ji fS ill C.i ijtl c3 482. Have they not traveled through the earth and seen what was the aid of those before them? They were more in number than them and mightier in strength, and in the traces in the land; yet all that they used to earn availed them not.} 483. Thai whai their Messengers came to than with clear proofs, they were glad (and proud) with that which they had of the biowledge (of worldly things). And that at which they used to mock, surrounded than.} 484. So when they saw Our punishmait, they said: "We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as (His) partners."} 485. Then their Faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants. And there the disbelievers lost utterly.}

509Surah 40. Ghafir (82 - 85) (Part-24) The Lesson to be learned from what happened to Those Who Came before Allah tells us about the nations who rejected their Messengers in ancient times. He mentioned the severe punishment they suffered despite their great strength, He mentioned the traces which they left behind in the earth and the great wealth they amassed. None of that availed them anything and could not prevent the punishment of Allah at all. That is because when the Messengers came to them with clear signs and decisive evidence, they did not pay any attention to them. Instead, they were content with the knowledge with them, or so they claimed, and they said that they did not need what the Messengers brought them. Mujahid said, "They said, we know better than them, we will not be resurrected and we will not be punished." * As-Suddi said, "In their ignorance, they rejoiced in what they had of (worldly) knowledge. So Allah sent upon them a punishment which they could not escape or resist." irti iand surrounded them.} means, encompassed them. 4that at which they used to mock,} means, that which they used to disbelieve in and said would never happen, u»} iSo when they saw Our punishment,} means, when they saw with their own eyes the punishment which came upon them, they said, 4We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as (His) partners.} means, they affirmed that Allah is One and denied the false gods, but this was at the time when excuses were to no avail. This is like what Fir'awn said as he was drowning: u B; '£ .4. c£c xS% 'A ^ iii At-Tabari 21 :422

41 believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims.} (10:90) But Allah said: 4\$'jo-JAR m jij <0:} 4N010 (you believe) while you refused to believe before and you were one of the the corrupters.} (10:91) meaning, Allah did not accept this from him, because He had answered the prayer of His Prophet Musa, when he said, ip vtdi &&& 4And harden their hearts, so that they will not believe until they see the painful torment} (10:88). Allah says here: 4Then their Faith coidd not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants.} means, this is the ruling of Allah concerning all those who repent only when they actually see the punishment: He does not accept that from them. It says in the Hadlth Gjfi-jju JbjJI 4jjj Jlu* (jj® «Alldh will accept the repentance of His servant so long as the death rattle is not sounding in his throat Once the death rattle is sounding and the soul has reached the throat, and the dying person actually sees the angel (of death), then he can no longer repent. Allah says: 4And there the disbelievers lost utterly.}

Surah 41: Fussilat

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 8

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5096]

Opening The TafslrofSurah Fussilat (Chapter - 41)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5096–5115]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. tvv gaaaga ^ mnmm z " » j! a~^@5ffCcJffAfLffc. (\'<:j Jijyj 2»^j Jlr-V^Xjv^_)JyS==>j5 'oyji^Oj^ otCr—*4 ^ * -<-«&& - 4£ JI *'•< £• 1 X\$(f-'_£\ jjj 1,-Sijpjl^ljJ*(>5<J^i> 5£^32UlsS&#f\$SglU>P>Gl^i LjMIJU Ic L-ij U>Jl2i &i: 4LK ;»:~-\$ r.ujijjo L/Ji. lilies p-4* (^A^=i ijijj I*ii tj. yi*> .Oydl-i V zjj 1i^Si li^ 4~,^ai itij & 3j 4? . Hfl Alfw.^ 42. A revelation from the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 43. A Boo/r whereof the Ayat are explained in detail - a Qur'an in Arabic for people who knoiv .> 44. Giving glad tidings and warning, but most of them turn away, so thei/ hear not.'} 45. And they say: "Our hearts are under coverings from that to which you This Surah is also known as Ha Mim As-Sajdah.

513Surah 41 . Fussilat (1-5) (Part-24) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.} (41:42). ifor people who know.} means, this clear style will be readily understood by scholars who are thoroughly versed in knowledge. 4Giving glad tidings and warning,} means, sometimes it brings glad tidings to the believers, and sometimes it brings a warning to the disbelievers. i V J>£k} ibut most of them turn away, so they hear not.} means, most of the Quraysh did not understand anything of it at all, despite the fact that it was so clear. xk 6\$ iAnd they say: "Our hearts are under coverings..."} meaning, they are wrapped and screened, Oj Cj'i'* ~jj4 &•} ifrom that to which you invite us; and in our ears is deafness,} means, "we are deaf to the message you bring to us.' iZX*. ialTJ ££ 'j*j} iand between us and you is a screen,} 'so nothing of what you say reaches us.' 4so work you (on your way); verily, we are working} means, go your way, and we will go our way, and we will not follow you. 3is&ES4 s*4M 13 Ui 21 a Hi 3} !£*• 5! (U i pij 0^=4' 'oj>3. V oj' 46. Say: "I am only a human being like you. It is revealed to

me that your God is One God, therefore take straight path to Him and obedience to Him, and seek forgiveness of Him. And woe to the polytheists 47. Those who give not the Zdkah and they are disbelievers in the Hereafter.} 48. Trtdy, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them will be an endless reward that will never stop. The Call to Tawhid Allah says, 4Say} 'O Muhammad, to these disbelievers and idolators,' 41 am only a human being like you. It is revealed to me that your God is One God,} 'not like these idols and false gods which you worship. Allah is one God,' 4i\$\\ !?££> 4therefbre take straight path to Him means, "worship Him Alone sincerely, in accordance with what He

has commanded you through His Messengers.' 4and seek forgiveness of Him} means, "for your past sins.' 4And woe to the polytheists.} means, doom and destruction is their lot. 4Those who give not the Zakdh} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that this means those who do not bear witness that there is no God except AllahJ This was also the view of 'Ikrimah.121 This is like the Ayat 111 At-Tabari 21 :430. ,2) At-Tabari 21 :430.

indeed he succeeds who purifies himself. And indeed he fails who corrupts himself.} (91:9-10) And; 4^1^ *,£^% indeed whosoever purifies himself shall achieve success. And remembers (glorifies) the Name of his Lord, and praus.} (87:14-15) And; A'.fM o' d> 2> iAnd say to him : "Would you purify yourself?"} (79:18) What is meant by Zakdh here is purification of the soul, ridding oneself of all bad qualities, the worst of which is Shirk. The Zakdh paid on one's wealth is so called because it purifies wealth, and it is a means of increasing it, blessing it and making it more beneficial, and a means of assisting one to use it in doing good deeds. Qatadah said, "They withheld the Zakdh of their wealth." This is the apparent meaning according to many of the scholars of Tafslr, and this is the view favored by Ibn Jarir.11 ' But the matter is subject to further examination, because the obligation of Zakdh was instituted during the second year after the Hijrah to Al-Madlnah, according to what is stated by several scholars. Yet this Ayah was revealed in Makkah. However, it is not unlikely that the principle of giving charity and Zakdh was already in place and had been enjoined at the beginning of the Prophet's mission, as Allah says: ibut pay the due thereof on the day of their harvest} (6:141). As for the details of Zakdh and how it is to be calculated according to the Nusub, were explained in Al-Madinah. This is how we may reconcile between the two opinions. Similarly, prayer was originally enjoined before sunrise and before sunset at the beginning of the Prophet's mission; it was only on the Night of the Isra', a year and a half before the Hijrah, that m At-Tabari 21 :431

Allah enjoined upon His Messenger jg the five daily prayers. The conditions and essential elements of prayer were explained later, in stages. And Allah knows best. Then Allah says: ip: c# \} Jp iTruly, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them will be an endless reward that will never stop.} Mujahid and others said, "It will never be cut off or decrease." This is like the Ayat iThey shall abide therein for ever.} (18:3) 4a gift without an end} (11:108) 4i> ril OjiPj gyj> 14 Tjil f ti Vri ->&> -irw tej* ce c>2L> Q JP P 13l» lip" ji Wjl» Oil ogjVb ^ SUo ^ Itisy tjli IUJi £r-* Qpab Jspi Jw"^ 49. Say: "Do you verily disbelieve in Him Who created the earth in two Days? And you set up rivals with Him? That is

the Lord of all that exists."} 410. He placed therein firm mountains from above it, and He blessed it, and measured therein its sustenance in four Days equal for all those who ask.} ill. Then He rose over (Istawd ild) the heaven when it was smoke, and said to it and to the earth : "Come both of you willingly or unwillingly." They both said: "We come willingly."} 412. Then He completed and finished their creation (as) seven heavens in two Days and He made in each heaven its affair. And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps (stars) to be an adornment as well as to guard. Such is the decree of Him, the Almighty, the All-Knower.} Some Details of the Creation of this Universe Here Allah denounces the idolators who worship other gods apart from Him although He is the Creator, Subduer and Controller of all things. He says: 4Say : "Do you verily disbelieve in Him Who created the earth in two Days? And you set up rivals with Him?"} meaning, false gods whom you worship alongside Him?'

44\$ 4That is the Lord of the that exists.} the Creator of all things is the Lord of all the creatures. Here the Ayah', <4 "3-} 4Who created the heavens and the earth in Six Days} (7:54). is explained in more detail; the creation of the earth and the creation of the heaven are discussed separately. Allah says that He created the earth first, because it is the foundation, and the foundation should be built first, then the roof. Allah says elsewhere: 4He it is Who createdJbr you all that is on the earth. Then He rose over (Istawd ild) the heaven and made them seven heavens}

iAre you more difficult to create or is the heaven that He constructed?} until; JibM iAnd after that He spread the earth.} (79:27-30) So He mentioned the creation of the heavens before the earth, then He said: i&l A 32. 4h&& fij iSay : "Do you verily disbelieve in Him Who created the earth in two Days?..."} until; }We come willingly.} Here He mentioned the creation of the earth before the creation of the heavens. And He says: 4 • T., I*#J by* iif o^j} iverily, Allah (Kona) is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful} (4:23). iMost Powerful, All-Wise} (4:56). ^All-Hearer, All-Seer} (4:58). It is as if He was and is no longer." Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, replied: 4<S£ Sji5-L Vj x^>j> 04 yii} iThere will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another} (23:101), this will happen when the Trumpet is blown for the first time. \$And all who are in the heavens and all who are on the earth will swoon away, except him whom Allah wills} (39:68), and at that time there will be no kinship among them, nor will "" K&na literally means "was".

they ask of one another. Then when the Sur will be blown again, 4And they will turn to one another and question one another} (37:27). With regard to the Ayat, 4W <\$} 4By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah} (6:23) and V} ibut they will never be able to hide a single fact from Allah} (4:42), Allah will forgive the sincere believers their sins, then the idolators will say, "Let us say that we never joined others in worship with Allah." Then a seal will be placed over their mouths, and their hands will speak. Then it will be known that not a single fact can be hidden from Allah, and at that point, 4those who disbelieved will wish} (4:42). Allah created the earth in two days, then He created the heavens, then He [Istawa. i/d) the heaven and gave it its shape in two more days. Then He spread the earth, which means that He brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture. And He created the mountains, sands, inanimate things, rocks and hills and everything in between, in two more days. This is

what Allah says: 4-^} 4(He) spread (the earth)} (79:30) And Allah's saying: ik L} 4(He) created the earth in two Days } So He created the earth and everything in it in fourdays, and He created theheavens in two days.

Svtrah 41 . Fussilat (9 - 12) (Part-24) 521 {verily, Allah (Kdna) is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful} (4:23). This is how He described Himself, and this is how He still is. Whatever Allah wills comes to pass, so do not be confused about the Qur'an, for all of it comes from Allah." This was recorded by Al-Bukhari. 1 ' {(He) created the earth in two Days} means, on Sunday and Monday. IsSLQ {He placed therein firm mountains from above it, and He blessed it,} means, He blessed it and gave it the potential to be planted with seeds and bring forth produce. <(f& {And measured therein its sustenance} means, what its people need of provision and places in which to plant things and grow crops. This was on Tuesday and Wednesday, which together with the two previous days add up to four days. {infour Days equalfor all those who ask.} meaning, for those who want to ask about that, so that they might know.

Tkrimah and Mujahid said concerning the Ayah: {< %& } {and measured therein its sustenance}: "He placed in every land that which is not suited for any other land."*2 * Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and As-Suddi said, concerning the Ayah, 111 Fath Al-B&ri 8 :418 121 At-Tabari 21 :436.

iequal for all those who ask): this means, "For whoever wants to ask about that." ' Ibn Zayd said: 4 £\$ ti iartd measured therein its sustenance in four Days equal for all those who ask.} "According to whatever a person who is need of provision wants, Allah measures out for him what he needs."12' This is like what they said concerning the Ayah: iAnd He gave you of all that you asked for (14:34). And Allah knows best. iThen He rose over (Istawa ila) towards the heaven when it was smoke,} i.e., steam which arose from it when the earth was created. 4 ^ C*?' U2\$|> <}& } iand said to it and to the earth : "Come both of you willingly or unwillingly."} meaning, Respond to My command and be subjected to this action, willingly or unwillingly.' iThey both said: "We come willingly."} meaning, "we will respond to You willingly and everything that You want to create in us - angels. Jinn and men - will all be obedient to You.' iThen He completed and finished their creation (as) seven heavens in two Days} means, He finished forming them as seven heavens in two more days, which were Thursday and Friday. i&jS £ j if-jj} At-Jabari 21 :438. [2 ' At-Jabari 21 :438.

523Surah 41. Fussilat (13 - 18) (Part-24) \$and He decreed in each heaven its affair. means, He placed in each heaven whatever it needs of angels and things which are known only unto Him. 4And We adorned the nearest (lowest) heaven with lamps means, the stars and planets which shine on the people of the earth. ias well as to guard. means, as protection against the Shayatin, lest they listen to the angels on high. 4^ iSuch is the Decree ofHim, the Almighty, the All-Knowerfr means, the Almighty Who has subjugated all things to His control, the All-Knower Who knows all the movements of His creatures. . >rt ,rrt ^ ^ ft; ^\$*£2 !£•* <14^ bisb Uj ^13. But i/ they turn away, then say: "I have warned you ofa Sa'iqah like the Sa'iqah which overtook 'Ad and Thamud.")> 414. When the Messengers came to them, from before them and behind them (saying): "Worship none but Allah," they said: "If our Lord had so willed. He would surely have sent down the angels. So, indeed vie disbelieve in that with which you have been sent 415. As for 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, m A thunderbolt or a lightning bolt.

524 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?" See they not that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them . And they used to deny Our Ayat!} 416. So, We sent upon them a Sarsar wind in days ofcalamity that We might give them a taste 'of disgracing torment in this present worldly life. But surely the torment of the Hereafter will be more disgracing, and they will never be helped. 417. And as for Thamud, We showed them the path of truth but they preferred blindness to guidance; so the Sa'iqah of disgracing torment seized them because of what they used to earn.} 418. And We saved those who believed and had Taqwa.} A Warning to the Disbelievers and a Reminder of the Story of'Ad andThamud Allah says: 'Say, O Muhammad, to these idolators who disbelieve in the message of truth that you have brought: If you turn away from that which I have brought to you from Allah, then I warn you of the punishment of Allah like the punishment that the past nations suffered for disbelieving in the Messengers.' 4*fV jlo j£* ii£o} 4a Sa'iqah like the Sa'iqah which overtook 'Ad and Thamud.} and other similar nations who did what they did. 4When the Messengers came to them, from before them and behind them} This is like the Ayah: 4zi&- ii-H C?* ui jxtl Jij juy

jilt Si >£ ul flj} 4And remember (Hud) the brother of 'Ad, when he warned his people in Al-Ahqaffat And surely, there have passed away warners before him and after him} (46:21). which means that in the neighboring towns and cities, Allah m Curved sand-hills in the southern part of Arabian Peninsula

sent Messengers who commanded the people to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate, and they brought good news as well as warnings. They saw the punishment Allah sent upon His enemies, and the blessings which He bestowed upon His friends, yet despite all of this, they did not believe in them. On the contrary, they denied them and rejected them, and said: & (2;& fr Hf our Lord had so willed. He would surely have sent down the angels. meaning, if Allah were to send Messengers, they would be angels sent from His presence. iSo, indeed we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent.) means, because you are a mere human; we will not follow you because you are just men like us.' 4Asfor 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right.} means, they were arrogant, stubborn and disobedient. iand they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?"} They boasted of their physical strength, and power; they thought that this would protect them from Allah's punishment. m& 33^ d3 ! £M iSee they not that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them.} means, do they not realize, when they are showing enmity, that He is the Almighty Who created all things and gave them whatever strength they have, and that His onslaught will be far greater? This is like the Ayah:

4With Hands did We construct the heaven. Verily, We are able to extend the vastness ofspace thereof. (51:47) They openly opposed the Almighty and denied His signs and disobeyed His Messenger. Allah said: iSo We sent upon them a Sarsar wind). Some said that this was a strongly blowing wind; others said that it was a cold wind. It was also said that it is the wind that makes a noise. The truth that it was all of these things, for it was a strong wind that was an apt punishment for their being deceived by their physical strength. It was also intensely cold, as Allah says: iwith a Sarsar wind!) (69:6), meaning a very cold wind. It also made a furious sound. Additionally, there is a famous river in the eastwhich is called Sarsar because of the noise it makes as it flows. <9&A& iin days ofcalamity) means, consecutive days, i- *61 ijfij Jli gL) ieven nights and eight days in succession) (69:7). This is like the Ayah ion a day ofcalamity, continuous) (54:19) i.e., the punishment began on a day which was of evil omen for them, and this evil omen continued for them, £1.) ieven nights and eight days in succession) (69:7) until they were destroyed, every last one of them, and their humiliation in this world was joined to their punishment in the Hereafter. Allah says: ithat We might give them a taste of disgracing torment in this present worldly life. But surely the torment of the Hereafter will

be more disgracing. meaning, more humiliating for them. iand they will never be helped.} means, in the Hereafter, just as they were never helped in this world, and they had no one who could protect them from Allah or save them from His punishment. iAnd as for Thamud, We showed them the path of truth Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Abu Al-Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said, "We explained to them." 1 11 Ath-Thawri said, "We called them." Allah's saying; ilfl \$ £& ibut they preferred blindness to guidance;} means, We showed them the truth and made it clear to them through the words of their Prophet Salih, but they opposed him and rejected him, and they slaughtered the she-camel of Allah which He had made a sign for them of the truth of their Prophet.' i&\ sjSJ iso the Sa'iqah ofdisgracing torment seized them^ means, Allah sent upon them the Sat/hah,121 earthquake, intense humiliation, punishment and torment. ibecause of what they used to earn> means,

because of their disbelief and rejection. *And We saved those who believed* means, **We saved them from among them, and no harm came *** At-Tabari 21 :448 Surah Had [11 :94] ' See volume five , the Tafslrof Surah HOd [1 1 :94)*

to them;' Allah saved them along with His Prophet Salih, peace be upon him, because of their fear of Allah. *And (remember) the Day that the enemies of Allah will be • gathered to the Fire, then they will be driven. Till, when they reach it, their hearing (ears) and their eyes and their skins will testify against them as to what they used to do.* 421. *And they will say to their skins, "Why do you testify against us?" They will say: "Allah has caused us to speak - as He causes all things to speak, and He created you the first time, and to Him you are made to return."* 422. *And you have not been hiding yourselves (in the world), lest your ears and your eyes and your skins should testify against you; but you thought that Allah knew not much of*

529 Surah 41. Fussilat (19 - 24) (Part-24 what you were doing.) 423. *And that thought of yours which you thought about your Lord, has brought you to destruction; and you have become of those utterly lost!* 424. *Then, if they bear the torment patiently, then the Fire is the home for them, and if they seek to please Allah, yet they are not of those who will ever be allowed to please Allah.* On the Day of Judgement, the Sinners' Limbs will testify against Them *And (remember) the Day that the enemies of Allah will be gathered to the Fire, then they will be driven.* means, remind these idolaters of the Day when they will be gathered to the Fire and they will be driven, i.e., the keepers of Hell will gather the first of them with the last of them, as Allah says elsewhere: *And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a thirsty state* (19:86). *Till, when they reach it,* means, when they stand at its edge, *ij& £» Si* pi** - pt?6 - 'x^ 4* their hearing (ears) and their eyes and their skins will testify against them as to what they used to do. means, all their deeds, earlier and later; not a single letter will be concealed. *4& 4* And they will say to their skins, "V^Jhy do you testify against they will blame their limbs and their skins when they testify against them, at which point their limbs will answer: *4&\$ %&%&& xsM& #i}*

530 Tafslr Ibn Kathir *They will say: "Allah has caused us to speak - as He causes all things to speak, and He created you the first time,* means, and He cannot be opposed or resisted, and to Him you will return. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar narrated that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah *jjg* laughed and smiled one day, and said: *ti/-"d o *Will you not ask about why I laughed?**" They said, "O Messenger of Allah, why did you laugh?" He said: *<3jI uyZi I# VI iJiaLl Jji V :J_jXi 4 ^ :Jli < : - JU - 5^lSil llfi^ h# atf IL iteji jjBgj Jli - ljl> f^il lii 11s </* was amazed at how a servant will dispute with his Lord on

the Day of Resurrection. He will say, "My Lord, did You not

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5115–5119]

promise me that you would not treat me unjustly?" Allah will say, "Yes." The man will say, "I will not accept any witness against me except from myself." Allah will say, "Is it not sufficient that I and the angels, the noble scribes, are witnesses?" These words will be repeated several times, then a seal will be placed over his mouth and his organs (or limbs) will speak about what he used to do. Then he will say,

"Away with you! It was only for your sake that I was arguing." V111 It was recorded by him and Ibn Abi Hatim.*2 * It was also recorded by Muslim and An-Nasal.*3 * Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Burdah said that Abu Musa said, "The disbeliever or the hypocrite will be called to account and his Lord will show him his deeds, but he will deny them and say, 'O Lord, by Your glory, this angel has written about me something that I did not do.' The angel will say to him, "Did you not do such 111 Al-HSkim 4:601. 121 At-Tabari 21 :452. I3 ' Muslim 4:2280, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :508

and such on such and such a day in such and such a place?' He will say, "No, by Your gloiy O Lord, I did not do it.' When he does that, a seal will be placed over his mouth." Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I think that the first part of his body to speak will be his right thigh." Allah's saying: i.And you have not been hiding yourselves (in the world), lest your ears and your eyes and your skins should testify against you;} means, their organs and skins will say to them, when they blame them for testifying against them, "you did not hide from us what you used to do, on the contrary, you openly committed disbelief and sin, and you claimed that you did not care, because you did not believe that Allah knew about all your deeds.' Allah says: na <i & 3 ibut you thought that Allah knew not much of what you were doing. And that thought of yours which you thought about your Lord, has brought you to destruction;} meaning, 'this evil thought, i.e., your belief that Allah did not know much of what you were doing, is what has caused you to be doomed and has made your losers before your Lord.' J. |» .i fc^ iand you have become of those utterly lost!} means, "in the place of Resurrection, you have lost your own selves and your families.' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I was hiding beneath the covering of the Kalaah, and three men came along - a man from the Quraysh and two of his brothers-in-law from Thaqif, or a man from Thaqif and two of his brothers-in-law from the Quraysh. Their bellies were very fat, and did not have much understanding. They said some words I could not hear, then one of them said, *Do you think that Allah can hear what we are saying now?'

iThey will say: "Our Lord! Our wretchedness overcame us, and we were (an) erring people. Our Lord! Bring us out of this. If ever we return (to evil), then indeed we shall be wrongdoers ." He will say: "Remain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!")" (23:106-108). * ift (*+*i*" &. l* 2a.ij) Ui \yL~> V i JU) \y& ^!>\ tS\$ \y3\ Uoi lilit \xf>£ *44^ £ *!/*• J'j jii jCJl {££. illj'i iylf ^ o?(*j iJ) Cfi liS-J jfall (ij) Lt) \ff.£==> qjjjl jlij fffojlf. u e&i ejca <25. And We have assigned for them intimate companions (in this world), who have made fair seeming to them, what was before them and what was behind them. And the Word is justified against them as it was justified against those who were among the previous generations of Jinn and men that had passed away before them. Indeed they (all) were the losers.) 426. And those who disbelieve say : "Listen not to this Qur'an, and make noise in the midst of its (recitation) that you may overcome.") 427. But surely, We shall cause those who disbelieve to taste a severe torment, and certainly, We shall requite them the worst of what they used to do.) 428. That is the recompense of the enemies of Allah : the Fire. Therein will be for them the eternal home, a recompense for that they used to deny Our Ayat.) 429. And those who disbelieve will say: "Our Lord! Show us those among Jinn and men who led us astray, that we may crush them under our feet so that they become the lowest.") The intimate Companions of the Idolators make Evil Actions attractive to Them Allah tells us that He is the One Who sends the idolators m At-Tabari 21 :458.

astray, and that this happens by His will and decree. He is the All-Wise in His actions, when He appoints for them close companions from among the devils of men and Jinn. iwho have made fair seeming to them, what was before them and what was behind them .} means, they made their deeds attractive to them in the past. As far as the future is concerned, they only see themselves as doing good, as Allah says: if- prji-'J ^ jfi cf iAnd whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious, We appoint for him a Shaytan to be a companion for him. And verily, they hinder them from the path, but they think that they are guided aright!} (43:36-37) &-j} iAnd the Word is justified against them} means, the Word of torment, just as it was justified against the nations of the past who did what they did, men and Jinn alike. 4Indeed they (all) were the losers.} means, they are all equal in terms of loss and being doomed.

How the disbelievers advised One Another not to listen

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5119–5126]

to the Qur'an, and the Recompense for that <Si !£3 * |£2T c\$ 4And those who disbelieve say: "Listen not to this Qur'an..."} means, they advised one another not to pay heed to the Qur'an or obey its commands. iand make noise in the midst of its} means, when it is recited, do not listen to it. This was the view of Mujahid. "And make noise in the midst of its (recitation)" means whistling and trying to

make the Messenger of Allah jg confused when he recited Qur'an, which is what the Quraysh did. i'oj& 4that you may overcome.} means, this is the practice of these ignorant disbelievers and those who follow in their footsteps, when they hear the Qur'an. Allah commanded us to be different from that, and said: 4Sor when the Qur'an is recited, listen to it, and be silent that you may receive mercy. (7:204). Then Allah says: Ijlic, [}J£ ouJl 4But surely. We shall cause those who disbelieve to taste a severe torment, meaning, in return for what they do when they hear the Qur'an. lSjJ" iand certainly. We shall requite them the worst of what they used to do. means, for their evil deeds. u oa o?& XQ jtli Ji\ u 0 g % iThat is the recompense of the enemies of Allah: the Fire. Therein will befar them the eternal home, a recompensefar that they used to deny Our Aydt. And those who disbelieve will say: "Our Lord! Show us those among Jinn and men who led us astray, that we may crush them under our feet so that they become the lowest."} It was reported that 'Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, said, concerning the phrase.

j^£45£s 5""! p iif £; yii 5»> 't'> vl- Kr.i< i.\$rv, ,, -JJXs-^r >&&&&\$5#5C -*rf- .?. <g)*11^ - C-50;Jljii^===e^l.6^^<^>jjtlZi\^ [q£j t^i !&3 *; 0L2 l^Ji jf jSft k^£ 4 £2 j£3j &*\$T 45 Qjii y^jl j^l|5 plljudi zj\& £ xz+i ot 'ij SoJc-ij £ l^j T'g^ 430. Verily, those who say: "Our Lord is Al- lah," and then they stand firm, on them the angels will descend (say- ing): "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised!"} i31 "We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and therein you shall have (all) for which you ask."} i32. "An entertainment from the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} Glad Tidings to Those Who believe in Allah Alone and stand firm QJJZX p lif c£ \)i 1{ } iVerily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah," and then they standfirm,} means, they do good deeds sincerely for the sake of Allah, and

they obey Allah, doing what Allah has prescribed for them. Ibn Jarir recorded that Said bin Imran said, "I read this Ayah to Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him: *Verily, those who say: 'Our Lord is Allah,' and then they stand firm,* He said, Those are the ones who do not associate anything with Allah." * 11 Then he reported a narration of Al-Aswad bin Hilal, who said, "Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, said, What do you say about this Ayah: *Verily, those who say: 'Our Lord is Allah,' and then they stand firm,*?' They said: *"Our Lord is Allah," and then they stand firm,* 'They shun sin.' He said, *You have not interpreted it improperly.' They say: 'Our Lord is Allah, then they stand firm and do not turn to any other god besides Him.' " *21 This was also the view of Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, As-Suddi and others . *31 Ahmad recorded that Sufyan bin 'Abdullah Ath-Thaqafi said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, tell me something that I can adhere to.' He said: *«Say, my Lord is Allah, then stand firm .»* I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, what do you fear most for me?' The Messenger of Allah took hold of the edge of his tongue and said, *«Ui» «This is .»* " *41 This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah; At-Tirmidhi said, Hasan Sahth. "151 111 At-Tabari 21 :464. 121 At-Tabari 21:464. At-Tabari 21:465. *41 Ahmad 3:413. [S] TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:91, Ibn Majah 2:1314.

539 Surah 41. Fussilat (30 - 32) (Part-24) Muslim also recorded it in his Sahih, and An-Nasab recorded that Sufyan bin 'Abdullah Ath-Thaqafi said, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, tell me something about Islam that I will not have to ask anyone about it after you.' He jg said: "Say: I believe in Allah, then stand firm." - then he mentioned the rest of the Hadith. • 1| 4 on them the angels will descend>. Mujahid, As-Suddi, Zayd bin Aslam and his [Zayd's] son said, "This means, at the time of death, and they will say, *iFear not^.* " *2 * Mujahid, 'Ikrimah and Zayd bin Aslam said, "This means not to fear "that which you will face in the Hereafter." *3 ' inor grieve! > Tor what you have left behind of worldly things, children, family, wealth and debt, for we will take care of it for you.' < But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised! } So they give glad tidings of the end of bad things and the arrival of good things. This is like what is said in the Hadith narrated by Al-Bara', may Allah be pleased with him: *v&J* tilly& v). JjZ Stfdl • jllip fi. Ij'j' jUJj J, JI .yr'ji- 1 tiLjiJ cJs* "The angels say to the soul of the believer, "Come out, O good soul from the good body in which you used to dwell, come out to rest, and provision and a Lord Wlw is not angry . " » *4 *** Muslim 1 :65. AJ-Tabari 21 :466, Al-Qurpibi 15:358. At-Tabari 21 :467. 141 Ahmad 4:287.

541 Surah 41 . Fussilat (33 - 36) (Part-24) 433. And who is better in speech than he who invites to Allah, and does righteous deeds, and says: "I am one of the Muslims." } 434. The good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal. Repel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. } 435. But none is granted it except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion in this world. } 436. And if an evil whisper from Shaytan tries to turn you away, then seek refuge in AllSh. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower. } The Virtue of calling Others to Allah 4\$ J{ fo oU & } 4 And who is better in speech than he who invites to Allah, } means, he calls the servants of Allah to Him. J^Zj } 4 and does righteous deeds, and says: "I am one of the Muslims." } means, he himself follows that which he says, so it benefits him as well as others. He is not one of those who enjoin good but do not do it themselves, or who forbid evil yet they do it themselves. He does good and avoids doing evil, and he calls people to

their Creator, may He be blessed and exalted. This is general in meaning and applies to everyone who calls people to

what is good and is himself guided by what he says. The

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Messenger of Allah is the foremost among people in this regard, as Muhammad bin Sirin, As-Suddi and ‘Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said.¹¹¹ It was also said that what was meant here is the righteous Mu’adhdhin, as it was mentioned in Sahih Muslim: •ylJl JliM JjU 111 Al-Qurtubi 15:360.

Wisdom in Da‘wah etc. }The good deed and the evil deed cannot be equal.} means, there is a huge difference between them. i^ j. JS,p} 4Repel (the evil) with one which is better,} means, “when someone does you wrong, repel him by treating him well,” as ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “There is no better punishment for one who has disobeyed Allah with regard to you, than your obeying Allah with regard to him.” cij\$ Jc53 4then verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he ivas a closefriend.} means, ‘if you treat well those who treat you badly, this good deed will lead to reconciliation, love and empathy, and it will be as if he is a close friend to you and he will feel pity for you and be kind to you.’ Then Allah says: ^ (id }But none is granted it except those who are patient} meaning, no one accepts this advice and works according to it, except for those who can be patient in doing so, for it is difficult for people to do. JL£- ji ^1 4and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion} means, the one who has a great portion of happiness in this world and in the Hereafter. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas explained this Ayah: “Allah commands the believers to be patient when they feel angry, to be forbearing when confronted with ignorance, and to forgive when they are mistreated. If they do this, Allah will save them from the Shaytan and subdue their enemies to them until they become like close friends. m Fath Al-Bari 8:418.

544 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 'fp U JZ&A }And if an evil whisper from Shaytan tries to turn you away, then seek refuge in Allah.} means, the devils among men may be deceived by your kind treatment of him, but the devils among the Jinn, when they insinuate their evil whispers, cannot be dealt with except by seeking refuge with the Creator Who gave him power over you. If you seek refuge with Allah and turn to Him, He will stop him from harming you and bring his efforts to naught. When the Messenger of Allah jg stood up to pray, he would say: Ij* dUaliJl 4U «J seek refuge in Allah the All-Hearing, All-Knowing, from the accursed Shaytan and his evil insinuations, breath and impurity,s”* 1 ' We have already stated that there is nothing like this in the Qur’an, apart from the passage in Surat Al-A‘raf, where Allah says: Zfr * # geiTv & Pi £} y%X -x iShow forgiveness, enjoin what is good, and turn away from the foolish. And ifan evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan, then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is All-Hearer, All- Knower.} (7:199-200) and the passage in Surat Al-Mu‘minun where Allah says: 4ir-* ot 4*5 <J*j {/* *4^ i—J ^ J Cjj Jl i/^oxklilf 4Repel evil with that which is better. VJe are Best-Acquainted with the things they utter. And say: “My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the whisperings of the ShaydtTn. And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they should come near me.”} (23:96-98) m Ahmad 5 :253

tA \ iLJ l U-Jy \ tE/ ^ \$E^ b •/v ?. *•* A «"> x •**"/, ^ •«' j ujAloljbL* 's*^' t^»_c->_gjiic'p_>pjj*-4-j'j' ^j^t5> ^jjcjc x ij^u •*>»» 1-1 .t » -*?i ^ -•*"" * J2K; pp-tfj 144P> p3s % ^plu » 0^ vJ^iU- l^Sl ^J. iiljisi^l uU tljl^ /d oJ»w4 iiEJ ujta * fij pj \$ \ kilil zA^jI* j^J ^ lfU& U)Il l}ji ixPLi- l5/> ££j]^ Qjj *L«Jl >X ^ lip*^ i£tp 4%£'-fe , 'i1 And from among His signs are the night and the day, and the sun and the moon. Do not prostrate yourselves to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, if you worship Him.} 438. But if they are too proud, then there are those who are with your Lord glorify Him night and day, and never are they tired.} 439. And among His signs; that you see the earth barren, but when We send down water to it, it is stirred to life and growth. Verily, He Who gives it life, surely is able to give life to the dead. Indeed He is Able to do all things.} From among the Signs of Allah Here Allah reminds His Creation of His power, and that He is the One Who has no equal, and He is Able to do all things. Allah's saying; 4J3S oUitj X&S J-4* & 4And from among His signs are the night and the day, and the J. <1 — d'.U

sun and the moon.} means. He created the night with its darkness and the day with its light, and they alternate without ceasing. And He created the sun with its shining light, and the moon with its reflected light, and He allotted their stages and gave them separate orbits in the heavens, so that by the variations in their movements man may know the stages of night and day, of weeks, months and years, and time periods related to people's rights, acts of worship and various transactions. Moreover, because the sun and moon are the most beautiful of the heavenly bodies that can be seen in both the upper and lower realms, Allah points out that they are created entities which are in a state of enthrallment to Him, subject to His dominion and control. So He says: 4Do not prostrate yourselves to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, if you (really worship Him.) meaning, 'do not associate anything in worship with Him, for your worship of Him will be of no benefit to you if you worship others alongside Him, because He does not forgive the association of others in worship with Him.' He says: \$} 4But if they are too proud,} i.e., to worship Him Alone, and they insist on associating others with Him, 4that there are those who are with your Lord} i.e., the angels. h ft & %&£} i glorify Him night and day, and never are they tired.} This is like the Ayah: l. Ij l*r } But if these disbelieve therein, then, indeed We have entrusted it to a people who are not disbelievers therein.} (6:89).

547 Surah 41 . Fussilat (40 - 43)(Part-24) 4And among His signs^ means, signs of His ability to bring the dead back to life. J&l Jj&} i that you see the earth barren,} means, lifeless, with nothing growing in it; it is dead. 4but when We send down water (rain) to it, it is stirred to life and growth.} means, it brings forth all kinds of crops and fruits. 41* & M.bP cp ZfM i Verily, He Wlto gives it life, surely is able to give life to the dead. Indeed He is Able to do all things.} 440. Verily, those who Yulhiduna Fi Our Ayat are not hidden from Us. Is he who is cast into the Fire better or he who comes secure on the Day of Resurrection? Do what you will. Verily, He is All-Seer of what you do.} 441. Verily, those who disbelieved in the Reminder when it came to them. And verily, it is an honorable well-fortified respected Book.} 442. Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.} 443. Nothing is said to you except what was said to the Messengers before you. Verily, your Lord is the Possessor of forgiveness, and (also) the Possessor of painful punishment.} The Punishment of the Deniers and the Description of the Qur'an tj (j3f\ 4Verily, Yulhiduna Fi Our Ayat}

Ibn ‘Abbas said, “ Al-tthad means putting words in their improper places.” Qatadah and others said, “It means disbelief and obstinate behavior.” 4^ tiyut l} ^are not hidden from Us.} This is a stem warning and dire threat, stating that He, may He be exalted, knows who denies His signs. Names and attributes, and He will punish them for that. He says: (*Jd 'ij'* tit tr* |** Jir l) 41s he who is cast into the Fire better or he who comes secure on the Day of Resurrection?} means, are these two equal? They are not equal. Then Allah warns the disbelievers: i'fii c \p\} 4Do what you will.} Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and ‘Ata’ Al- Khurasani said that ipL C \p\} 4Do what you will.} is a threat. * Meaning, ‘do what you will of good or evil, for He knows and sees all that you do.’ He says: 4j 4 Verily, He is All-Seer of what you do.} iVerily, those who disbelieved in the Reminder when it came to them.} Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and Qatadah said, “This is the Qur’an.”*3 * 1 45^ 4-^P fy} 4And verily, it is an honorable well-fortified respected Book.} means, it is protected and preserved, and nobody can produce m At-Tabari 21 :478. *2! At-Tabari 21 :478. At-Tabari 21 :479.

549 Surah 41 . Fussilat (44 - 45) (Part-24) anything like it. Cri Yj V} 4Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it,} means, there is no way to corrupt it, because it has been sent down by the Lord of the worlds. Allah says: i(it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.} meaning, He is Wise in all that He says and does, Praiseworthy in all that He commands and forbids; everything that He does is for praiseworthy purposes and its consequences will be good. 4^5 Jj 1C vi jil' £} 4Nothing is said to you except what was said to the Messengers before you.} Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said, “Nothing is said to you by way of rejection and disbelief, that was not said to the Messengers who came before you. Just as you have been rejected, they were also rejected. Just as they bore then- people’s insults with patience, so too you must bear your people’s insults with patience.”111 sij} iVerily, your Lord is the Possessor of forgiveness,} means, for those who turn to Him in repentance. iand (also) the Possessor of painful punishment.} means, for those who persist in disbelief, transgression and stubborn opposition. vs v && vji;U & Jy u<: fg m At-Jabari 21 :481

444. And if We had sent this as a Qur’an in a foreign language, they would have said: “Why are not its verses explained in detail? What! Not in Arabic nor an Arab?” Say: “It is for those who believe, a guide and a cure. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them. They are called from a place far away.”} 445. And indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, but dispute arose therein. And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and the matter would have been settled between them. But truly, they are in grave doubt thereto.} Rejection of the Qur’an is pure Stubbornness Allah tells us that the Qur’an is so eloquent and perfect in its wording and meanings, yet despite that the idolators do not believe in it. He tells us that their disbelief is the disbelief of stubbornness, as He says elsewhere: jom jp iij; j 4And if We had revealed it unto any of the non-Arabs, and he had recited it unto them, they would not have believed in it.} (26:198-199). If the Qur’an had been revealed in the language of the non- Arabs, they would have said, because of their stubbornness: 4Why are not its verses explained in detail? What! not in Arabic and an Arab?} meaning, why is it not revealed in detail in Arabic? And by way of denunciation they would have said, “What! not in Arabic nor from an Arab? - i.e., how can foreign words be revealed to an Arab who does not understand them? This interpretation was reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Tkrimah, Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi and others. 4"&*j — Ji \$} 4Say : “It is for those who believe, a guide and a cure. . .”} m At-Tabari 21 :482

means, 'say, O Muhammad: this Qur'an, for the one who believes in it, is guidance for his heart and a cure for the doubts and confusion that exists in people's hearts.' i^jpP tj iAnd as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears,) means, they do not understand what is in it. £)) iand it is blindness Jbr them.) means they are not guided to the explanations contained therein. This is like the Ayah y ^ o', ijoj) iAnd We send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe, and it increases the wrongdoers nothing but loss.) (17:82). iThey are called from a place far away.) Mujahid said, "Far away from their hearts."111 Ibn Jarir said, "It is as if the one who is addressing them is calling to them from a distant place, and they cannot understand what he is saying."*21 This is like the Ayah: *>< ,, S ft faj (P. tc& jjjt yjt ^f) iAnd the example of those who disbelieve is as that of him who shouts to those (flock of sheep) that hears nothing but calls and cries. (They are) deaf, dumb and blind. So they do not understand.) (2:171) Taking Musa as an Example ils 6&Z j.p ui: iAnd indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, but dispute arose 111 At-Tabari 21 :485. 121 At-Tabari 21 :484.

TafsirWn KathTr " cams iAr a V, therein.} 'jJ4 means, they 'A- t . 4, 'f - disbelieved in him „d did not show him J-3.J@ jHiCr3litS.li=Ji any respect. 0.^icgsfowS^Sftf?: 5* api !*S3icr^ iL^ 0"S>jS iTherefore be patient as '>. i ^ did the Messengers of strong will} (46:35). iJ^£A c jiiJJJ t ii.llij had it not been for >.<' <f • s.s 'Jt'A * a Word that went forth ^ before from your Lord,} -^juol-A^; iA> i.c., to delay the \>'A,>'<'i'Z , '*{' y<r >'Z Reckoning until the Day of Resurrection, 4'^4-e 4fhe matter would have — been settled between them.} means, the punishment would have been hastened for them. But they have an appointed time, beyond which they will find no escape. iyJ S?#J\$0 iBut truly, they are in grave doubt thereto.} means, their words of disbelief are not due to any wisdom or insight on, their part; rather they spoke without any attempt at examining it thoroughly. This was also the interpretation of Ibn Jarir, and it is a plausible interpretation. 1 11 And Allah knows best. ^ JV, ^Z'u> U .a ,fi'i lilXo TC-! < At-Tabari 21 :487.

pyj Vj cy J-y* Oi •jir*-' Oi ft/f 0^ iy^ li l*r* J-ij ui L4. ^ ' _>!U c5»lS=/“ £|>'uy^ oi l* 'yk# J- 446. laftsoeuer does righteous good deed, it is for himself; and whosoever does evil, it is against himself. And your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) servants .) 447. To Him is referred the knowledge of the Hour. No fruit comes out of its sheath, nor does a female conceive nor brings forth (young), except by His knowledge. And on the Day when He will call unto them (saying): "Where are My (so-called) partners?" They will say: "We inform You that none of us bears witness to it!") 443. And those whom they used to invoke before (in this world) shall disappear from them, and they will perceive that they have no place of refuge.) Everyone will be requited according to His Deeds 4*4_Jlu ^Whosoever does righteous good deed, it is for himself;) means, the benefit of which will come to him. 4&£& iand whosoever does evil, it is against himself.) means, the consequences of that will come back on him. 'Mb iAnd your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) servants) means, He only punishes people for their sins, and He does not punish anyone except after establishing proof against him and sending a Messenger to him. Knowledge of the Hour is with Allah Alone Then Allah says: 4To Him is referred the knowledge of the Hour.) meaning, no one

554 Tafstr Ibn Kathir knows about that apart from Him. Muhammad jg, the leader of mankind, said to Jibril, who is one of the leading angels, when he asked him about the Hour: JjllLlU& j&l. JjjjJl "The one

who is asked about it does not know more than the one who is askingJ" And Allah says: 4To your Lord belongs the term thereof.} (79:44) iNone can reveal its time but He} (7:187). cr" "it & jyc cj : yj~ 4No fruit comes out of its sheath, nor does a female conceive nor brings forth (young), except by His knowledge.} means, all of that is known to Him, and nothing is hidden from your Lord the weight of a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven. Allah says: vt i_ ijj Ji Cj} 4not a leaf falls, but He knows it} (6:59). ix* Cj Cj ill & U jSs> iAllah knows what every female bears, and by how much the wombs fall short or exceed. Everything with Him is in (due) proportion} (13:8). iAnd no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easy for Allah.} (35:11) pr.i£ fyj} m Fath Al-Bari 1 :140

555 Surah 41 . Fussilat (49 - 51) (Part-25) iAnd on the Day when He will call unto them (saying) "Where are My (so-called) partners?"} means, on the Day of Resurrection, Allah will call out to the idolators before all of creation and say, "Where are My partners whom you worshipped besides Me?" iThey will say: "We inform You..."} means, "we tell You," Cfi Q {that none of us bears witness to it.} means, 'not one of us will bear witness today that You have any partner.' iAnd those whom they used to invoke before (in this world) shall disappear from them,} means, they will go away, and will be of no benefit to them. ih (A iand they will perceive that they have no place of refuge} means, they will have no way of escaping from the punishment of Allah. This is like the Ayah: iAnd the criminals shall see the Fire and apprehend that they have to fall therein. And they will find no way of escape from there.} (18:53) IS 45 jSi « pz ill) JjJj iijli 4 UCa i*. .Zj Uj y ygfs*. W . a >/ ^ yy < <49. Mm does not get tired of asking for good; but if an evil touches him, then he gives up all hope and is lost in despair.} i50. And truly, if We give him a taste of mercy from Us, after some adversity has touched him, he is sure to say: "This is due to my (merit); I think not that the Hour will be established.

But if I am brought back to my lord, surely there will be for me the best with Him. "Then, We verily will show to the disbelievers what they have done, and We shall make them taste a severe torment.} i51 . And when We show favor to man, he turns away and becomes arrogant; but when evil touches him, then he has recourse to long supplications.} Man is fickle when Ease comes to Him after Difficulty Allah tells us that man never gets bored of asking his Lord for good things, such as wealth, physical health, etc., but if evil touches him - i.e., trials and difficulties or poverty — then he gives up all hope and is lost in despair.}, i.e., that he will never experience anything good again. 44 a* o* llj 2jrz> Odj} he thinks iAnd truly, if We give him a taste of mercy from Us, after some adversity has touched him, he is sure to say : "This is due to my (merit)..."} means, if something good happens to him or some provision comes to him after a period of difficulty, he says, this is because of me, because I deserve this from my Lord.' 41 think not that the Hour will be established.} means, he does not believe that the Hour will come. So when he is given some blessing, he becomes careless, arrogant and ungrateful, as Allah says: *2 A Cpj# kft 4Nay! Verily, man does transgress. Because he considers himself self-sufficient.} (96:6) Qj 0\$} 4But if I am brought back to my Lord, surely there will be for me the best with Him .} means, *if there is a Hereafter after all, then my Lord will be

generous and kind to me just as He was in this world.' So he expects Allah to do him favors in spite of his bad deeds and lack of certain faith. Allah says: 4Then, We verily will show to the disbelievers what they have done, and We shall make them taste a severe torment.} Thus Allah threatens punishment and

vengeance to those whose conduct and belief is like that. 4And when We show favor to man, he turns away and becomes arrogant;} means, he turns away from doing acts of obedience and is too proud to obey the commands of Allah. This is like the Ayah\ 4But [Fir awn] turned away along with his hosts} (51:39). 41b\iM^} 4but when evil touches him,} means, difficulties, j*} 4then he has recourse to long supplications.} means, he asks at length for one thing. Long supplications are those which are long on words and short on meaning. The opposite is concise speech which is brief but full of meaning. And Allah says: £ £2.& ft £\$ jl i| 6C: yU £ tfr 4And when harm touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him!} (10:12) Zf li jM j*j oi, t») Ji^ Ojj; (JliVf tjj. lijJ* . 7Xju \$i ft Z&& Ji Z>, 4rk^ }£\$\$& HA. iffr'L i 452. Say: "Tell me, if it is from Allah, and you disbelieve in it? Who is more astray than one who is in opposition far away."} 453. We will show them Our signs in the universes, and within themselves, until it becomes manifest to them that this is the truth. Is it not sufficient in regard to your Lord that He is a Witness over all things?} 454. Lo, Verily, they are in doubt concerning the meeting with their Lord. Verily, He is surrounding all things!} The Qur'an and the Proofs of its Truth Allah says: iSay} - 'O Muhammad, to these idolaters who disbelieve in the Qur'an 0j[>1**\$} 4Tell me, if it} - this Qur'an - 4' 0*£= 3;^ 4is from Allah, and you disbelieve in it?} means, *what do you think your position is before the One Who revealed it to His Messenger?' Allah says: 4 j* ir-t 4-^ 4Who is more astray than one who is in opposition far away.} means, he is in a state of disbelief, stubbornness and opposition to the truth, and is following a path that leads far away from guidance. Then Allah says: 4We will show them Our signs in the universe, and within themselves,} meaning, *We will show them Our evidence and proof that the Qur'an is true and has indeed been sent down from Allah to

559 Surah 41 . Fussilat (52 - 54) (Part-25) the Messenger of Allah, through external signs, 4in the universe},' such as conquests and the advent of Islam over various regions and over all other religions. Mujahid, Al- Hasan and As-Suddi said, "And signs within themselves means,

the battle of Badr, the conquest of Makkah, and other events

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5144–5145]

which befell them, where Allah granted victory to Muhammad jg and his Companions, and inflicted a humiliating defeat on falsehood and its followers." It may also be that what is meant here is man and his physical composition. As detailed in the science of anatomy, which indicates the wisdom of the Creator - may He be blessed and exalted - and the different inclinations and opposite natures that people have, good and bad, etc., and the (divine) decrees to which man is subjected, having no power to change and over which he has no control. ^ ill <£*> iuntil it becomes manifest to than that this (the Qur'an) is the truth. Is it not sufficient in regard to your Lord that He is a Witness over all things?} means, sufficient is Allah as a Witness over the words and deeds of His servants, and He beau's witness that Muhammad is telling the truth in what he says, as Allah says: i -vA -A iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you; He has salt it down with His knowledge} (4:166). 4 (»rl 4Lo, Verily, they are in doubt concerning the meeting with their Lord.} means, they doubt that the Hour will come, they do not think about it or strive for it or pay heed to it; on the contrauy, they regard it as

irrelevant and do not care about it. But it will undoubtedly come to pass. Then Allah states that He is Able to do all things and He encompasses all things, and it is very easy for Him to bring about the Hour:

{Verily, He is surrounding all things!} means, all of creation is subject to His control, dominion and knowledge; He is controlling all things by His power, so whatever He wills happens, and whatever He does not will does not happen, and there is no god worthy of worship apart from Him.

Surah 42: Ash-Shura

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5146–5196]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAsh-Shura (Chapter - 42) Whichwas revealed in Makkah * \$ In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. _»)' \$ tiUj ut iff (J|> 4 a c y>'p^*** lip 02 Oj. '« l*r-> ot ^ uj\$' 4*i Jiji ill £\$ iyj/> jjiif f:: • 43 . Ha Mxm.} 42. 'Am Sin Qaf.} 43. Likewise Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise sends revelation to you as to those before you .} 44. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and He is the Most High, the Most Great.} 45. Nearly the heavens might be rent asunderfrom above them, and the angels glorify the praises of their Lord, and ask for forgiveness for those on the earth. Lo, Verily, Allah is the Oft-

It was also reported in the Two Sahihs, and the version quoted here is that recorded by Al-Bukhari. 4 Cj c&lii 4 £ 4To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth,} means, everything is subject to His dominion and control. iand He is the Most High, the Most Great.} This is like the Ayat. ithe Most Great, the Most High} (13:9), and iW&W 4He is the Most High, the Most Great} (22:62). And there are many similar Ayat. rJZ m 4Nearly the heavens might be rent asunderfrom above them,} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ka*b Al-Ahbar said, "Out of fear of His might."*21 iand the angels glorify the praises of their Lord, and ask for forgivenessfor those on the earth.} This is like the Ayah: V** "Ajr «S*5 ojij? iThose who bear the Throne and those around it glorify the praises of their Lord, and believe in Him, and ask forgiveness for those who believe (saying) : "Our Lord! You comprehend all 111 Fath Al-B&ri 1 :25, Muslim 4:1816. 121 Al-Tabari 21:501.

ithat you may warn the Mother of the Towns}, i.e., Makkah, ^and all around it,} means, all the lands, east and west. Makkah is called Umm Al-Qura (the Mother of the Towns) because it is nobler than all other lands, as indicated by much evidence that has been discussed elsewhere. Among the most concise and clear proofs of that is the report recorded by Imam Ahmad from 'Abdullah bin 'Adi bin Al-Hamra' Az-Zuhri, who heard the Messenger ofAllah jg say, as he was standing in the market ,place ofMakkah; U kili; 'ifij l4ll Wilt vLLl jlljt "By Allah, you are the best land of Allah, the most beloved land to Allah; were it not for the fact that I was driven out from you, I would never have left you. This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah; At-Tirmidhi said, uHasan Sahih.'*2] P g 'j&} iand warn (them) of the Day ofAssembling} i.e., the Day of Resurrection, when Allah will assemble the first and the last in one plain. Cjj iofwhich there is no doubt,} means, there is no doubt that it will happen and will most certainly come to pass. 4a party will be in Paradise and a party in the blazing Fire,} This is like the Ayah: (J. fS), 4(And remember) the Day when He will gather you (all) on the 111 Ahmad 4:305. TuhfatAl-Ahwardhi 10 :426 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 2 :479 , Ibn MSiah

or taken away from it.» The Companions of the Messenger of Allah said, “Why should we strive if it is something that is already cut and dried?” The Messenger of Allah Jg said: “J** ih* 51j ‘jU’ Jil d jtJl C->-U» jjj ®Strive with your deeds as hard as you can far middle course or close to it, far the person who is destined for Paradise will die doing the deeds of the people of Paradise, regardless of what he did before, and the person who is destined far Hell will die doing the deeds of the people of Hell, regardless of what he did before.» Then he sg made a gesture with his Fist and said, uYour Lord has settled the matter of His servants » and he opened his right hand as if throwing something; *A party in Paradise .» and he made a similar gesture with his left hand; *And a party in the blazing Fire.o”* 1 ' This was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasal; At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih Ghanb.’W Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Nadrah said, “One of the Companions of the Prophet Ig, whose name was Abu Abdullah, was visited by some of his friends, and they found him weeping. They asked him, What has caused you to weep? Didn’t the Messenger of Allah Jg say to you, •^ui: JU- 1\$ p ilijLi ja Ahmad 2 :167. See the following note. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :350 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubrti 6 :452 . The chain of this Hadith contains a narrator over whose reliability there is a difference of opinion. The majority consider it an authentic Hadth.

idf) 02 fk £ . *i£> 4 *25 <>* j£3j^ ibut He admits whom He units to His mercy. And the wrongdoers will have neither a protector nor a helper. cj }&\$\$\$ 4P<^ jia iut^ ^»vj cXk=>j jit jl jj Juj ^ W-uJ ^*iVt Sy in £) S**r \jgi5 chilli u*i >J-D' -t-fi o\$9 cJLLIS\ JLiCu ^.,?-l> v -fl .yfK 4<?.|yp Jc? 49. Or have they taken protecting friends besides Him? But Allah - He Alone is the protector. And He Who gives life to the dead, and He is Able to do all things.} 410. And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah. Such is Allah, my Lord in Whom I put my trust, and to Him 1 him in repentance.} ill. The Creator of the heavens and the earth. He has made for you mates from yourselves, and for the cattle (also) mates. By this means He creates you. There is nothing like Him, and He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer.} 412. To Him belong the keys of the heavens and the earth. He enlarges provision for whom He wills, and straitens. Verily, He is the All-Knower of everything .} Allah is the Protector, Ruler and Creator Here Allah denounces the idolators for taking other gods instead of Allah, and declares that He is the True God, and it is not right to worship anyone except Him Alone. He is the One Who is able to bring the dead back to life and He is Able to do all things. Then He says: 4^ 3l w jsE3 4And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah.} means, in whatever issue you differ. This is general in meaning and applies to all things.

4\$^ J) 4the decision thereof is with Allah.} means, He is the Judge of that, according to His Book and the Sunnah of His Prophet sg . This is like the Ayah: 4*)j-J’j 4 J’, ‘S>j j f^-jZ 4(And) if you differ in anything amongst yourselves, refer it to Allah and His Messenger} (4:59). iSuch is Allah, my Lord} means, (He is) the Judge of all things. 44J ity&} 4itt Whom 1 put my trust, and to Him I turn in repentance.} means, 1 refer all matters to Him.’ 4The Creator of the heavens and the earth.} means, the Maker of them both and everything in between. 4&\$ ce 4He has made for you mates from yourselves,} means, of your own kind. As a blessing and a favor from Him, He has made your kind male and female. -AVt ^} iand for the cattle (also) mates.} means, and He has created for you eight pairs of cattle. 4By this means He creates you.} means, in this manner He creates you, male and female, generation after generation of men and cattle. 4”^ .4\$ Sfr 4There is nothing like Him,} means, there is nothing like the Creator of these pairs, for He is the Unique, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who has no peer or equal.

4JUKyL1(%) 4He is the All-Hearer, the All-Seer.} 4To Him belong the keys of the heavens and the earth.} We have already discussed the interpretation of this phrase in Surat Az-Zumar (39:63), the conclusion of which is that He is the One Who is controlling and governing them. 4He expands provision for whom He wills, and straitens.} means, He gives plentiful provision to whomsoever He wills and He reduces it for whomsoever He wills, and He is perfectly Wise and Just. 4Verily, He is the All-Knower of everything.} 413. He (Allah) has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Nuh, and that which We have revealed to you, and that which We ordained for Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it. Intolerable for the idolators is that to which you call them. Allah chooses for Himself whom He wills, and guides unto Himself who turns to Him in repentance.} 414. And they divided not till after knowledge had come to them, through transgression between themselves. And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord for an appointed term, the matter would have been settled between them. And verily, those who were made to inherit the Scripture after them, are in grave doubt concerning it.}

is saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it•> meaning, Allah enjoined all the Prophets (peace and blessings of Allah be upon them all) to be as one and He forbade them to differ and be divided. 4Intolerable for the idolators is that to which you call them.} means, 'it is too much for them to bear, and they hate that to which you call them, O Muhammad, i.e., Tawhid.' 4-4-^ J* ISJ-rrJ 5* *\$l iAlldh chooses for Himself whom He wills, and guides unto Himself who turns to Him in repentance.} means, He is the One Who decrees guidance for those who deserve it, and decrees misguidance for those who prefer it to the right path. Allah says here; ^ ot il C>j} iAnd they divided not till after knowledge had come to them,} means, their opposition to the truth arose after it had come to them and proof had been established against them. Nothing made them resist in this manner except their transgression and stubbornness. di in ijis} 4And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord for an appointed term,} means, were it not for the fact that Allah had already decreed that He would delay the reckoning of His servants until the Day of Resurrection, the punishment would have been hastened for them in this world. Si LAo' Cftfi* i^Sb iAnd verily f those who were made to inherit the Scripture after them,} means, the later generation which came after the earlier

generation which had rejected the truth. iare in grave doubt concerning it.} means, they do not have any firm conviction in matters of religion; they merely imitate their forefathers, without any evidence or proof. So they are very confused and doubtful. *it Jpt fcj jij Vj ojij cr^ pj u C;# \$2* y4=> 45 ££& ffe 425. So unto this then invite (people), and stand firm as you are commanded, and follow not their desires but say : "I believe in whatsoever Allah has sent down of the Book and I am commanded to do justice among you. Allah is our Lord and your Lord. For us our deeds and for you your deeds. There is no dispute between us and you. Allah will assemble us (all), and to Him is the final return."} This Ayah includes ten separate and independent ideas, each of which is a ruling on its own. They (the scholars) said that there is nothing else like it in the Qur'an, apart from Ayat Al- Kursi [2:255], which also includes ten ideas. iSo unto this then invite (people),} means, 'so call people to this which We have revealed to you and which We enjoined upon all the Prophets before you,' the Prophets of major ways [of SharVah] that were followed, such as the Messengers of strong will, and others. iand stand firm as you are commanded,} means, 'adhere firmly, you and those who follow you, to the worship of Allah as

He has commanded you.' iand follow not their desires} means, the desires of the idolators, in the falsehoods that they have invented and fabricated by worshipping idols.

ibut say : "I believe in whatsoever Allah has sent down of the Book..."} means, I believe in all the Books that have been revealed from heaven to the Prophets; we do not differentiate between any of them.' ipz. 'S& SjJ} iand I am commanded to do justice among you.} means, when judging according to the commands of Allah. 1%&} iAllah is our Lord and your Lord.} means, 'He is the One Who is to be worshipped, and there is no true God but He. We affirm this willingly, and even though you do not do so willingly, everyone in the universe prostrates to Him obediently and willingly.' pj&A tJ} iFor us our deeds and for you your deeds.} means, *we have nothing to do with you.' This is like the Ayah: JH) >^1 pH pj j ffi jpp ifj} }And if they demy you, say: "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent ofwhat you do!"} (10:41) iThere is no dispute between us and you.} Mujahid said, "This means, no argument."111 As-Suddi said, "This was before Ayah of the sword was revealed." This fits the context, because this Ayah was revealed in Makkah, and Ayah of the sword [22:39- 40] was revealed after the Hijrah. m At-Tabari 21 :518.

r. S > -1 •(\$C^2&© 4i^5^4A^l\ \$& \$^j&y yjfi^Jjyi^fcjitijO^ *# JX- [>?•?.'-Ji\i:~j 'V *— --/' <*. \M.E (g)**\$£&(#^u4%> < :?(v - f>-f">x { >"2: 0 kssfy tggggjyi® V. 4Allah will assemble us >-->' !<•- il (all),} means, on the Day of Resurrection. This is like the Ayah: jwu ,4 U*j Ljo< x*y_ £3 jij cr 'it& iSay : "Our lord will assemble us all together, then He will judge be- tween us with truth. And He is the just judge, the All-Knower of the true state of affairs."} (34:26). 4and to Him is the final return .} means, the final return on the Day of Reckoning. 6 4 c6>fA*: U.\$0 '* C ui ^ £>& (*+*J v-Si- prJ ^4 *Jos}i &&. * 6rff 4. <04 &&& <^~V icdJ' 4 ii' j[^ o_Ai~i £: 4}**-* Ir*' 4-S-00" 416 . And those who dispute concerning Allah, after it has been accepted, of no use is their dispute before their Lord and on them is wrath, and for them will be a severe torment.} 417. It is Allah Who has sent down the Book in truth, and the Balance. And what can make you know that perhaps the Hour is close at hand?} 418. Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those

577Surah 42. Ash-Shurd (16-18) (Part-25) who believe are featful of it, and know that it is the very truth. Verily, those who dispute concerning the Hour are certainly in errorfar away.} AWarning to ThoseWho dispute concerning Matters of Religion Here Allah warns those who try to hinder those who believe in Allah, from following His path. Ji 4 iAnd those who dispute concerning Allah, after it has been accepted,} means, those who dispute with the believers who have responded to Allah and His Messenger, and tiy to stop them from following the path of guidance. <in?J ino use is their dispute before their Lord} means, it is futile before Allah. 4and on them is wrath,} means, from Him. <4*2 £>& iand for them will be a severe tonnent.} means, on the Day of Resurrection. Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and Mujahid said, "They disputed with the believers after they responded to Allah and His Messenger, and tried to prevent them from following the path of guidance, hoping that they would return to Jahiliyyah."il] Qatadah said, "These were the Jews and Christians who said to them, 'Our religion is better than your religion, our Prophet came before your Prophet, and we are better than you and closer to Allah than you.'",2, This was nothing but lies. Then Allah says: i\$. \ C3S# XS& At-Tabari 21 :518, 519. At-Tabari 21 :519.

578 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr Alī is Allāh Who has sent down the Book in truth, referring to all the Books which were revealed from Him to His Prophets. ik4^ iand the Balance.} means, justice and fairness. This was view of Mujahid and Qatadah. 111 This is like the Ayat. A b -i" ; c-'lipL \jlLj !&} the AIndeed We have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs, and revealed with them the Scripture and the Balance that mankind may keep up justice (57:25). JJ AAnd the heaven He has raised high, and He has set up the Balance. In order that you may not transgress (due) balance. And observe the weight with equity and do not make the balance deficient.>(55:7-9) A<^J S»S JJ &jl £& AAnd what can make you know that perhaps the Hour is close at hand?} This is encouragement (to strive) for its sake, a terrifying warning, and advice to think little of this world. 'oPm v •ofj'^ AThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it,} means, they say, "when will this promise be fulfilled, if you are telling the truth?" But they say this by way of disbelief and stubbornness, thinking that it is unlikely to happen. ip \p: ^M} Awhile those who believe are fearful of it} means, they are afraid of it happening. A& 8pz^} Aand know that it is the very truth.} means, that it will m At-Tabari 21 :520.

undoubtedly come to pass, so they prepare themselves for it and strive for its sake. It was reported through various chains of narration, a number reaching the level of being Mutawatir, in Sahih and Hasan narrations, in the Books of Sunan and Musnad. According to some versions, a man addressed the Messenger of Allāh ^ in a loud voice, when he was on one of his journeys, calling out to him, "O Muhammad!" The Messenger of Allāh jg replied in a similar manner, "Here I am!" The man said, "When will the Hour come?" The Messenger of Allāh said, LJj ojji p f Ui Zi\ S I4J1 •Woe to you! It will most certainly come. What have you done to prepare for it? He said, "Love for Allāh and His Messenger." He sg said: •You will be with those whom you /ove.^ According to another Hadith: •"A man will be with those whom he loves .»12' This is Mutawatir beyond a doubt. The point is that he did not answer his question about when the Hour would happen, but he commanded him to prepare for it. iVerily, those who dispute concerning the Hour means, who dispute whether it will happen and think it is unlikely ever to come, iare certainly in error far away.} means, they are clearly ignorant, because the One Who created the heavens and the earth is even more able to give life to the dead, as Allāh says: 111 Fath Al-B&ri 10:573, Muslim 4:2033 ^ Muslim 4 :2034

{And no moving creature is there on the earth but its provision is due from Allāh. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book (11:6) And there are many similar Ayat. \$He gives provisions to whom He wills. means, He gives generously to whomsoever He wills. iAnd He is the All-Strong, the Almighty.> means, there is nothing that can overpower Him. Then Allāh says: ^Whosoever desires the reward of the Hereafter, means, whoever does things for the sake of the Hereafter, 4We give him increase in his reward meaning. We will give him strength and help him to do what he wants to do, and We will increase it for him. So for every good, We will multiply it and give him between ten and seven hundred good rewards,' as much as Allāh wills. j.,. , ; , ji 4 •#ij' Cjji efy- 4and whosoever desires the reward of this world, We give him thereof, and he has no portion in the Hereafter.> means, whoever strives for the purpose of worldly gains, and never pays any heed to the Hereafter at all, Allāh will deny him the Hereafter; and in this world, if He wills He will give to him and if He does not will, he will gain neither. So the one who strives with this intention in mind will have the worst deal in this world and in the Hereafter. The evidence for that is the fact that this Ayah is reinforced by the passage in Subhan (i.e., Surat Al-Isrd) in which Allāh says: ^ as uq 2 uiu i;. s?^ ^ U &.J iS^R & 53

Whoever desires the quick-passing, We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have appointed for him Hell; he will (enter) therein disgraced and rejected. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer - then such are the ones whose striving shall be appreciated. On each - these as well as those - We bestow from the bounties of your Lord. And the bounties of your Lord can never be forbidden. See how We prefer one above another (in this world), and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment. (17:18-21) It was reported that Ubayy bin Kah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Give the glad tidings to this Ummah of sublimity, high status, victory and power in the land. But whoever among them does the deeds of the Hereafter for the sake of worldly gain, will have no portion of the Hereafter.'" 111 Making Legislation for the Creatures is Shirk Allah says: 'Or have they partners with Allah who have instituted for them a religion which Allah has not ordained?' means, they do not follow what Allah has ordained for you of upright religion; on the contrary, they follow what their devils (Shayatin), of men and Jinn, have prescribed for them. They instituted taboos, such as the Bahirah, Sa'ibah, Was'iah or // dm. I 1 ' Ahmad 5:134. ,a| For an explanation of these, see volume three, the Tafsir of Surat Al-M'idah 5:103.

They also permitted eating flesh and blood of animals not slaughtered for consumption, gambling and other kinds of misguidance, ignorance and falsehood. These are things that they invented during Jahiliyyah, when they came up with all kinds of false rulings on what was permitted and what was forbidden, and false rites of worship and other corrupt ideas. It was recorded in the Sahih. that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'I saw 'Amr bin Luhayy bin Qama'ah dragging his intestines in Helb [I] - because he had been the first one to introduce the idea of the Sa'ibah. This man was one of the kings of the Khuza'ah tribe, and he was the first one to do these things. He was the one who had made the Quraysh worship idols, may the curse of Allah be upon him. Allah said: 'And had it not been for a decisive Word, the matter would have been judged between them.' means, the punishment would have been hastened for them, were it not for the fact that it had already been decreed that it would be delayed until the Day of Resurrection. 'And verily, for the wrongdoers there is a painful torment.' i.e., an agonizing torment in Hell, what a terrible destination. The Terror of the Idolaters in the Place of Gathering 'You will see the wrongdoers fearful of that which they have earned,' means, in the arena of Resurrection. 'and it will surely befall them.' means, the thing that they fear will undoubtedly happen to them. This is how they will be on the Day 111 Path Al-Bari 6:633.

of Resurrection; they will be in a state of utter fear and terror. 'But those who believe and do righteous deeds (will be) in the flowering meadows of the Gardens. They shall have whatsoever they desire with their Lord.' What comparison can there be between the former and the latter? How can the one who will be in the arena of resurrection in a state of humiliation and fear, deserving it for his wrongdoing, be compared with the one who will be in the gardens of Paradise, enjoying whatever he wants of food, drink, clothing, dwellings, scenery, spouses and other delights such as no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and has never crossed the minds of men. Allah says: 'The ultimate victory and complete blessing.' means, the ultimate victory and complete blessing.

423. That is whereof Allah gives glad tidings to His servants who believe and do righteous good deeds. Say: "No reward do I ask of you for this except to be kind to me for my kinship with you." And whoever earns a good righteous deed. We shall give him an increase of good in respect thereof. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Ready to appreciate.} 424. Or say they: "He has invented a lie against Allah?" If Allah willed, He could have sealed up your heart. And Allah wipes out falsehood, and establishes the truth by His Word. Verily, He knows well what are in the breasts.} Good News of the Blessings of Paradise for the People of Faith Having mentioned the gardens of Paradise, Allah then says to His servants who believe and do righteous deeds: 4 That is whereof Allah gives glad tidings to His servants who believe and do righteous good deeds. meaning, this will undoubtedly come to them, because it is glad tidings from Allah to them. 4 of \$ 4 * 10 & 4 Say : "No reward do I ask of you for this except to be kind to me for my kinship with you."} means, 'say, O Muhammad, to these idolaters among the disbeliever of Quraysh: I do not ask you for anything in return for this message and sincere advice which I bring to you. All I ask of you is that you withhold your evil from me and let me convey the Messages of my Lord. If you will not help me, then do not disturb me, for the sake of the ties of kinship that exist between you and I.' Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, was asked about the Ayah: 4 ^ 4 except to be kind to me for my kinship with you.} Sa'Id bin Jubayr said, "To be kind to the family of Muhammad." Ibn 'Abbas said, "No, you have jumped to a hasty conclusion. There was no clan among Quraysh to whom

to you of the Qur'an.' This is like the Ayah: Ji lij liLi) Jkjlis' jLu tde JjS ^j} 4 S j3 if he had forged a false saying concerning Us (Allah), We surely would have seized him by his right hand, and then We certainly would have cut off his life artery, And none of you could have withheld Us from (punishing) him.} (69:44-47) which means, *We would have wrought the utmost vengeance upon him, and no one among mankind would have been able to protect him.' And Allah said: <4*6 SB i and establishes the truth by His Word.} means, He establishes it and strengthens it and makes it clear by His Words, i.e., by His evidence and signs. 4-pilJ' jyj} i Verily, He knows well what are in the breasts.} means, all that is hidden in the hearts of men. itjf ' jSyOjL*^ t b j&y cAell\ cf \yjoj .jjCj jc- i^l' J-i ifj5l j*j} iit jJj £>Ue ^ Jj'i y>J l* yJi IJiJ .£3 i45S c jJ? Si 5531 425. And He it is Who accepts repentance from His servants, and forgives sins, and He knows what you do.} 426. And He answers those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and gives them increase of His bounty. And as for the disbelievers, theirs will be a severe torment.} 427. And if Allah were to extend the provision for His servants, they would surely rebel in the earth, but He sends down by measure as He wills. Verily, He is, in respect of His servants, the Well-Aware, the All-Seer.} 428. And He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired, and spreads His mercy. And He is the Wall, Worthy of all praise.}

589 Surah 42. Ash-Shura (25 - 28) (Part-25) It was reported that Az-Zuhri said, concerning this Ayah, that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: iilk l>I wiliu jLSLLil ,^3 cJCi Jt>J tjle Xt'ft U-y jLl(iu» tAllah rejoices more over the repentance of His servant than one of you feels when he finds his lost camel in a place where he had feared that he would die of thirst.' •I Hammam bin Al-Harith said, "Ibn Mashad was asked about a man who commits immoral sins with a woman and then marries her. He said, There is nothing wrong with that,' and recited: 4' }&e iAnd He it is Who accepts repentance from His servants ^." *2 i and forgives sins,) means, He will accept repentance in the future, and He forgives past sins. 4o>L*u Li i and He knows what you do.) means. He knows all

your deeds and actions and words, yet He still accepts the repentance of those who repent to Him. ijUu Tjit iAnd He answers those who believe and do righteous good deeds,) As-Suddi said, “This means, He responds to them.” This was also the view of Ibn Jarir: “It means that He answers their supplication for themselves, their companions and their brothers.”*3 4‘jU* ii *** ‘Abdur-Razzaq 3 :191 . This narration is supported by the previous. 121 At-Tabari 21 :533. At-Tabari 21 :534.

591Surah 42 . Ash-Shitra (25 - 28) (Part-25) those who deserve to be poor. £ jJu CK J/1 iAnd He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired,} means, after the people have given up hope that rain will fall, He sends it down upon them at their time of need. This is like the Ayah: ^ J *4^1* CJt J 0A 'Jj'i 0* ^ iAnd verily, before that (rain) - just before it was sent down upon them - they were in despair!} (30:49) iand spreads His mercy.} means, He bestows it upon all the people who live in that region. Qatadah said, “We were told that a man said to TJmar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, ‘O Commander of the faithful, no rain has come and the people are in despair.’ TJmar, may Allah be pleased with him, said, ‘Rain will be sent upon you,’ and he recited: i&LfX cij! jij 'A ('-'Xi Km'> —*> CK oj* iS. iAnd He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired, and spreads His mercy. And He is the Protector, Worthy of all praise}.’ Meaning He is the One Who is in control of His creation, taking care of what will benefit them in this world and the Hereafter, and the consequences of all His decrees and actions are good, for which He is worthy of all praise. **—— 1*+^ Cri >£. £j C?j} i29. And among His Ayat is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and whatever moving creatures He has dispersed in them both. And He is Able to assemble them whenever He |i| At-Tabari 21 :537.

592 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr wills.} 430. And whatever of misfortune befalls you, it is because of what your hands have earned. And He pardons much.} 431. And you cannot escape from Allah in the earth, and besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.} Among the Signs of Allah is the Creation of the Heavens and the Earth 4And among His Ayat} the signs which point to His great might and power, 4is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and whatever moving creatures He has dispersed in them both.} means, whatever He has created in them, i.e., in the heavens and the earth. 4and whatever moving creatures} this includes the angels, men, Jinn and all the animals with their different shapes, colors, languages, natures, kinds and types. He has distributed them throughout the various regions of the heavens and earth. 4And He} means, yet despite all that, tSj. 4is Able to assemble them whenever He wills.} means, on the Day of Resurrection, He will gather the first and the last of them, and bring all His creatures together in one place where they will all hear the voice of the caller and all of them will be seen clearly; then He will judge between them with justice and truth. The Cause of Misfortune is Sin i&J lii Oi pifcSJi %}

iAnd whatever of misfortune befalls you, it is because of what your hands have earned. means, “whatever disasters happen to you, O mankind, are because of sins that you have committed in the past.” iAnd He pardons much.} means, of sins; “He does not punish you for them, rather He forgives you.” igK oi C, J.3 1 iV -I'X 4And i/ Al/d/i twere to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth (35:45). According to a Sahth Hadith: isyh JU Ki. Jii fis “By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, no believer is stricken with fatigue, exhaustion, worry or grief, but Allah will forgive him for some of his sins thereby - even a thorn which pricks himV 11

Imdm Ahmad recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg\$ say: Cri ii *** iiiii Jt at «No physical harm befalls a believer, but Allah will expiate for some of his sins because of it.»"121 Imam Ahmad also recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, "The Messenger of Allah 3^5 said: j-aji Juj iiiii ;^si , u ii-Mpj Juuii iSji *If a person commits many sins and has nothing that will expiate for them, Allah will test him with some grief that will (1) Ahmad 2:303. Ahmad 4 :98. Similar was recorded by Muslim no. 6567.

JH tAV wmm expiate 'Cj*3 <40)2?j-fl'ci*-4Aj Oijl'«Uy j&i'p'Outiy \$Jp Af-'f ,< - > ,, Irf 1A1 : • A\\'t ' ; '*< ' ^3t&otjfoiJPu>Qpqftf0i(*-®L («TJci^J * Go!fi^Ll l^lc- (>»jIgilj&1> ^ <J-^ ti!J-* v'-^' !j!>^ ybr themj'W j j'ji' 5\$>^ ts. 4 %j&r 4 51 **£«& i£ j\$5j oi&» f:J2. yu; \$ s\$ ' *•" \>"f ,, '.»•. > AOr Uj J4**j> j' ti SjLi2 c*ii j&y ^ 02 |vi l» Lij'» <32 . And among His signs are the ships in the sea like mountains.} 433. If He wills. He causes the wind to cease, then they would become motionless on the surface (of the sea). Verily, in this are signs for every- one patient and grateful .} 434. Or He may destroy them because of that which their (people) have earned And He pardons much.} 435. And those who dispute as regards Our Ayat may know that there is no place of refuge for them.} Ships are also among the Signs of Allah Allah tells us that another sign of His great power and dominion is the fact that He has subjugated the sea so that ships may sail in it by His command, so they sail in the sea like mountains. This was the view of Mujahid, Al-Hasan, As- Suddi and Ad-Dahhak. In other words, these ships on the sea *** Ahmad 6:157. The chain of narrators is deficient but it may be considered to have support from the previous narration

are like mountains on land. ilfHe wills, He causes the wind to cease,} means, the winds that cause the ships to travel on the sea. If He willed, He could cause the winds to cease, then the ships would not move and would remain still, neither coming nor going, staying where they are on the surface of the water. dJl'i 4 iVerily, in this are signs for everyone patient} means, who is patient in the face of adversity iand grateful.} means, in the fact that Allah has subjugated the sea and He sends as much wind as they need in order to travel, there are signs of His blessings to His creation for everyone who is patient, i.e., at times of difficulty, and grateful, i.e., at times of ease. iOr He may destroy them because of that which their (people) have earned.} means, if He wills, He may destroy the ships and drown them, because of the sins of the people on board. if <3*,} iAnd He pardons much.} means, of their sins; if He were to punish them for all of their sins, He would destroy everyone who sails on the sea. Some of the scholars interpreted the Ayah iOr He may destroy them because of that which their (people) have earned.} as meaning, if He willed, He could send the wind to blow fiercely so that it would take the ships and divert them from their courses, driving them to the right or the left, so that they |i) At-Tabari 21 :541

597 Surah 42. Ash-Shura (36 - 39) (Part-25) l , The Attributes of Those Who deserve that which is with Allah Here Allah points out the insignificance of this worldly life and its transient adornments and luxuries. iSo whatever you have been given is but (a passing) enjoyment far this worldly life.} means, no matter what you achieve and amass, do not be deceived by it, for it is only the enjoyment of this life, which is the lower, transient realm that will undoubtedly come to an end. ibut that which is with Allah is better and more lasting means, the reward of Allah is better than this world, and it will last forever, so do not give preference to that which is transient over that which is lasting. Allah says: ifor those who believe} means, for those who are patient in forgoing the pleasures of this world, *£> &s} iand put their

trust in their Lord.} means, so that He will help them to be patient in doing what is obligatory and avoiding

what is forbidden. Then Allah says: iAnd those who shun the greater sins, and Al-Fawahish,} We have already discussed sin and Al-Fawahish in Surat Al- A'raf. w iand when they are angry, they forgive.} means, their nature dictates that they should forgive people and be tolerant. 111 See SuratAl-A'raf:33

598 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Vengeance is not in their nature. It was reported in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ never took revenge for his own sake, only when the sacred Laws of Allah were violated. iAnd those who answer the Call of their Lord,} means, they follow His Messenger jg and obey His commands and avoid that which He has prohibited. iand perform As-Salah} - which is the greatest act of worship of Allah, may He be glorified. Tprt |*VL>r iand who (conduct) their affairs by mutual consultation,} means, they do not make a decision without consulting one another on the matter so that they can help one another by sharing their ideas concerning issues such as wars and other matters. This is like the Ayah: iand consult them in the affairs} (3:159). The Prophet used to consult with them concerning wars and other matters, so that they would feel confident. When Umar bin al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, was dying, after he had been stabbed, he entrusted the choice of the next Khalifah to six people who were to be consulted. They were Uthman, 'Ali, Talhah, Az-Zubayr, Sa'd and 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf, may Allah be pleased with them all. Then all of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, agreed to appoint Uthman as their leader. iand who spend of what We have bestowed on them.} this means kindly treating the creation of Allah, starting with those who are closest, then the next closest, and so on. f& (\$>} m FathAl-B&ri 10:541.

4And those who, when an oppressive wrong is done to them, take revenge. means, they have the strength to take revenge on those who commit aggressive wrong and hostile acts against them. They are not incapable of doing so and they are not helpless; they are able to take revenge against those who transgress against them, even though when they have the power to take revenge, they prefer to forgive, as when Yusuf, peace be upon him, said to his brothers: ip isuz J# 4No reproach on you this day; may Allah forgive you^ (12:92). even though he was in a position to take revenge on them for what they had done to him. The Messenger of Allah jg forgave the eighty people who intended to do him harm during the year of Al-Hudaybiyah, camping by the mountain of At-Tan'im. When he overpowered them, he set them free, even though he was in a position to take revenge on them. He also forgave Ghawrath bin al-Harith who wanted to kill him and unsheathed his sword while he was sleeping. The Prophet jg woke up to find him pointing the sword at him. He reproached him angrily and the sword dropped. Then the Messenger of Allah picked up the sword and called his Companions He told them what had happened, and he forgave the man. There are many similar Hadiths and reports. And Allah knows best. Pi •* 'A Its # 'P cfepp \p& Jj p k; Jp Jr . ^ U Jii -U> j rj # U 'jjSp rftZf # <20 Jh J&\ 440. The recompense for an evil is an evil like thereof; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah. Verily, He likes not the wrongdoers. 441 . And indeed whosoever takes revenge after he has suffered wrong, for such there is no way (of blame) against them. 442 . The way is only against those who oppress men and rebel in the earth without justification; for such there will be a

600 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir painful torment.} 443. And verily, whosoever shows patience and forgives, that would truly be from the things recommended by Allah.} Forgiving or exacting Revenge on Wrongdoers

4The recompense for an evil is an evil like thereof}. This is like the Ayat ipt c&^ & tOSH £>} iThen whoever transgresses the prohibition against you, you transgress likewise against him} (2:194), and 4And if you punish, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted} (16:126). Justice, has been prescribed, in the form of the prescribed laws of equality in punishment (Al-Qisas), but the better way, which means forgiving, is recommended, as Allah says: iand wounds equal for equal. But if anyone remits the retaliation by way of charity, it shall be for him an expiation} (5:45). Allah says here: &&} ibut whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah.} means, that will not be wasted with Allah. As it says in a Sahih Hadith ,l'je Sii Sij u;i tAllah does not increase the person who forgives except in honorJ'W m Muslim 4 :2001

<Verily, He likes not the wrongdoers.) means, the aggressors, i.e., those who initiate the evil actions.)And indeed whosoever takes revenge after he has suffered wrong, for such there is no way (of blame) against them.) means, there is no sin on him for taking revenge against the one who wronged him. 4The way) means, the burden of sin, Ji« ijfjVi 4 o'® jjiiki J?) iis only against those who oppress men and rebel in the earth without justification;) means, those who initiate wrongful actions against others, as it says in the Sahih Hadith j£iJ Li Vli Li jIT:.'..* lli When two persons indulge in abusing each other, the one who initiated the wrongful action is to blame, unless the one who was wronged oversteps the mark in retaliation. Il] ifor such there will be a painful torment.) means, intense and agonizing. It was reported that Muhammad bin Wasi' said, "I came to Makkah and there was a security out post over the trench whose guards took me to Marwan bin Al-Muhallab, who was the governor of Basrah. He said, What do you need, O Abu 'Abdullah?' I said, *If you can do it, I need you to be like the brother of Banu 'Adiy.' He said, Who is the brother of Banu 'Adiy?' He said, 'Al-'Ala' bin Ziyad; he once appointed a friend of his to a position of authority, and he wrote to him: If you can, only go to sleep after you make sure that there is nothing on your back [i.e., you do not owe anything to anyone], your Muslim 4 :2000 .

602 TafsTr Ibn Kathir stomach is empty and your hands are untainted by the blood or wealth of the Muslims. If you do that, then there will be no way (of blame) against you - j?" LfjV" 4 J'® 477ie uwy is only against those who op- press men and rebel in the earth without justifi- cation; for such there will be a painful torment. Marwan said, 'He spoke the truth, by Allah, and gave sincere advice.' Then he said, What do you need, O Abu 'Abdullah?' I said, I need you to let me join my family.' He said, "Yes [I will do that)."' 111 This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. When Allah condemned wrongdoing and the people who do it, and prescribed Al-Qisas, He encouraged forgiveness: iAnd verily, whosoever slwvs patience andforgives,} meaning, whoever bears the insult with patience and conceals the evil action, ^&&& 4that would truly befrom the things recommended by Allah.} ^ Ibn Abi Shaybah 7 :245

Said bin Jubayr said, "This means, one of the things enjoined by Allah," i.e., good actions for which there will be a great reward and much praise. 444. And whomsoever Allah sends astray, for him there is no protector after Him. And you will see the wrongdoers, when they behold the torment, they will say: "Is there any way of return?"} 445. And you will see them brought forward to it (Hell) made humble by disgrace, (and) looking with stealthy glance. And those who believe will say: "Verily, the losers are they who lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection." Verily, the wrongdoers will be in a lasting torment.} 446. And they will have no protectors to help them other than Allah. And he whom

Allah sends astray, for him there is no way.} The State of the Wrongdoers on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us that whatever He wills happens and whatever He does not will does not happen, and no one can make it happen. Whomever He guides, none can lead astray, and whomever He leads astray, none can guide, as He says: 4but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no protecting to lead him.} (18:17). Then Allah tells us about the wrongdoers, i.e., the idolaters who associate others in worship with Allah - \%a} 4when they behold the torment,} i.e., on the Day of Resurrection, they will wish that they could go back to this world.

604 Tafslr Ibn Kathir as j£ 4they will say: "Is there any way of return?"} This is like the Ayah: j; <y, o/S Gj <\$4% y* uii. ijiiii^ lji> ^ a; ftt~# ft^&* 3? at0# iX a^\$ ilf you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say : "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Ayat of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to them what they had been concealing before. But if they were returned, they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars.) (6:27-28) r+o>j7 4And you will see them brought forward to it) means, to the Fire. 44-iri 'ot imade humble by disgrace,) means, in a befitting manner, because of their previous disobedience towards Allah. 4&- at <?>}&.) 4(and) looking with stealthy glance.) Mujahid said, "In a humiliated manner."111 That is, they will steal glances at it, because they will be afraid of it. But the thing that they are afraid of will undoubtedly happen, and worse than that - may Allah save us from that. 4And those who believe will say) means, on the Day of Resurrection they will say: lit 4Verily, the losers...) means, the greatest losers. m At-Tabari 21 :553.

iare they who lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection.} means, they will be taken to the Fire and deprived of any pleasures in the Hereafter. They will lose themselves, and they will be separated from their loved ones, companions, families and relatives, and they will lose them. iVerily, the wrongdoers will be in a lasting torment.} means, everlasting and eternal, with no way out and no escape. OJJ Jt £j} iAnd they will have no protectors to help them other than Allah.} means, no one to save them from the punishment and torment which they are suffering. (i U ii> Ji^i i o*j} iAnd he whom Allah sends astray, for him there is no way.} means, no salvation. ^ oi £ d>' <-3; \$ yf y of. J oi '*** oi &sj?- 13 4 oj oji Lj Aixi. oij lij: Qj it. Ciil ^47. Answer the Call of your Lord before there comes from Allah a Day which cannot be averted. You will have no refuge on that Day nor there will be for you any denying.} i48. But if they turn away, We have not sent you as a Hafiz over them. Your duty is to convey. And verily, when We cause man to taste of mercy from Us, he rejoices there at; but when some evil befalls them because of the deeds which their hands have sent forth, then verily, man (becomes) ingrate!}}

Encouragement to obey Allah before the Day of Resurrection When Allah tells us about the horrors and terrifying events of

i\p -Ji 4Your duty is to convey .4 meaning, 'all that We require you to do is to convey the Message of Allah to them.' 4^, {fr lij CijS 'ij verily, when We cause man to taste of mercy from Us, he rejoices there at;> means, when a time of ease and comfort comes to him, he is happy about it. 4but when befalls them} means mankind. isome evil} means, difficulty, drought, punishment. tribulation or 4then verily, man (becomes) ingrate!} means, he forgets the previous times of ease and blessings and acknowledges nothing but the present moment. If times of ease come to him, he becomes arrogant and

transgresses, but if any difficulty befalls him, he loses hope and is filled with despair. This is like what the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to the women: «يَا أَيُّهَا النِّسَاءُ خُذْنَ زِينَتَكُمْ وَأَعْلَنُوا بِأَرْجُلِكُنَّ لِلرِّجَالِ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ» «O women, give in charity, for I have seen that you form the majority of the people of Hell. A woman asked, “Why is that, O Messenger of Allah?” He said: «رَبُّكُمْ» «Your Lord» «... if something good happens to him, he is thankful, and that is good for him. If something bad happens to him, he bears it with patience, and that is good for him. This does not happen to anyone except the believer. In the Paradise of the believers, the women are like the angels. To Allah belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He creates what He wills. He bestows female upon whom He wills, and bestows male upon whom He wills.} 450. Or He bestows both males and females, and He renders barren whom He wills. Verily, He is the All-Knower and is Able (to do all things).} Allah tells us that He is the Creator, Sovereign and Controller of the heavens and the earth. Whatever He wills happens, and whatever He does not will does not happen. He gives to whomsoever He wills and withholds from whomsoever He wills; none can withhold what He gives, and none can give what He withholds, and He creates whatever He wills. S3 PisP> iHe bestows female upon whom He wills.} means, He gives them daughters only. Al-Baghawi said, “And among them (those who were given daughters only) was LUt, peace be upon him.”121 Pi iatid bestows male upon whom He wills.} means, He gives them sons only. Al-Baghawi said, “Like Ibrahim Al-KhaM, peace be 111 Muslim 4:2295. ^ Al-Baghawi 4 :132

This is the case with most women, except for those whom Allah guides and who are among the people who believe and do righteous deeds. As the Prophet said, the believer is the one who: ip- .pi tip. lj tii ip- Si* .pi tip oui ji» «... if something good happens to him, he is thankful, and that is good for him. If something bad happens to him, he bears it with patience, and that is good for him. This does not happen to anyone except the believer. n Pi PPj lip its Pi p; tip C pp'ij piui Jii P*p pj* »IP P Jpj Luib jl Pp_0' ^49. To Allah belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. He creates what He wills. He bestows female upon whom He wills, and bestows male upon whom He wills.} 450. Or He bestows both males and females, and He renders barren whom He wills. Verily, He is the All-Knower and is Able (to do all things).} Allah tells us that He is the Creator, Sovereign and Controller of the heavens and the earth. Whatever He wills happens, and whatever He does not will does not happen. He gives to whomsoever He wills and withholds from whomsoever He wills; none can withhold what He gives, and none can give what He withholds, and He creates whatever He wills. S3 PisP> iHe bestows female upon whom He wills.} means, He gives them daughters only. Al-Baghawi said, “And among them (those who were given daughters only) was LUt, peace be upon him.”121 Pi iatid bestows male upon whom He wills.} means, He gives them sons only. Al-Baghawi said, “Like Ibrahim Al-KhaM, peace be 111 Muslim 4:2295. ^ Al-Baghawi 4 :132

upon him, who did not have any daughters.”111 iOr He bestows both males and females,} means, He gives to whomsoever He wills both males and females, sons and daughters. Al-Baghawi said, “Like Muhammad 4and He renders barren whom He wills.} means, so that he has no children at all. Al-Baghawi said, “Like Yahya and Isa, peace be upon them.”131 So people are divided into four categories: some are given daughters, some are given sons, some are given both sons and daughters, and some are not given either sons or daughters, but they are rendered barren, with no offspring. 4Verily, He is the All-Knower means, He knows who deserves to be in which of these categories. 4jj& iand is Able (to do all things).} means, to do whatever He wills and to differentiate between people in this manner. This issue is similar to that referred to in the Ayah where Allah says of Isa, peace be upon him: 4And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind} (19:21): i.e., proof for them of His power, for He created people in four different ways. Adam, peace be upon him, was created from clay, from neither a male nor a female. Hawwa', peace be upon her, was created from a male without a female. All other people, besides “Isa, peace be upon him, were created from male and female, and this sign of Allah was completed with the creation of Isa bin Maiyam, may peace be upon them both, who was created from a female without a male. Allah says: iS -X&X4j} Al-Baghawi 4 : 132 121 Al-Baghawi 4 : 132 131 Al-Baghawi 4 : 132

J tA* mmm Uj »LlJ \J> f")lj g @aB% 31 CiJjJ \$ ^j\^^==Jji3 ^jLi^p bj^e-j^— CJA^jVI
 SLA*U^V5O^il! ^-ngliUl Ep j&Rj&Jjs^jff \$i^%£*j&L \n4A«d (We w/s/i) to appoint him as a sign to
 mankind (19:21). This issue has to do with parents, whilst the previous issue has to do with children,
 and in each case there are four categories. Glory be to the All-Knower Who is Able to do all things. J
 JLA ty 0 ''' ^\ t\ly ot } &-J . r i -«• > v» a - < •> *t uf'jr' X>^j J?v! J * ::,v w ^ >'i >r<x .»',>-^=«. # /
 C) .Li* u li _4 ^4 U^, 1^4 Slj 4^4-i' (i tiyS £ .t ./< ,*.r~ v >'vm cf-<4 iy> <£4? tili^J t.J.-C ^4 iLl> O4 .
 4^ * ^t>? d! "£& ^ dl "S/^ uf d t*j d £ 4iii 4o^e 451 . It is not given to any human being that Allah
 slwuld speak to him unless (it be) by revelation, orfrom behind a veil, or (that) He sends a Messenger to
 reveal what He wills by His leave. Verily, He is Most High, Most Wise . 452. And thus We have sent to
 you Riih of Our command. You knew not what is the Book, nor what is Faith. But We have made it a
 light wherewith We guide whosoever of Our servants We will. And verily, you are indeed guiding to a
 straight path.} 453. The path of Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the
 earth. Verily, all matters at the end go to Allah.}

How the Revelation comes down

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5196–5198]

This refers to how Allah sends revelation. Sometimes He casts something into the heart of the Prophet
 jg, and he has no doubt that it is from Allah, as it was reported in Sahth Ibn Hibban that the Messenger
 of Allah jg said: ‘tfU-lj Ifijj ^ Lli of vi-i; Op fal l Iy^>-fj 4)1 Iyili «Ar-Ruh Al-Qudus [i.e., Jibril]
 breathed into my heart that no soul will die until its allotted provision and time have expired, so have
 Taqwd ofAllah and keep seeking in a good (and lawful) u>ay .»111 tflo Cfi jfa ior from behind a veil} -
 as He spoke to MQsa, peace be upon him. He asked to see Him after He had spoken to him, but this
 was not granted to him. In the Sahth, it recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Jabir bin
 ‘Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him: JU-Us ijrf aJlJ »ijj fjA 'it io>-f <ii Us oAllah never speaks
 to anyone except from behind a veil, but He spoke to yourfather directly.^ This is how it was stated in
 the Hadith. He (Jabir’s father) was killed on the day of Uhud, but this refers to the realm of Al-
 Barzakh, whereas the Ayah speaks of this earthly realm. <£* U •‘Ai% ior (that) He sends a Messenger
 to reveal what He wills by His leave.} as Jibril, peace be upon him, and other angels came down to the
 Prophets, peace be upon them. iVerily, He is Most High, Most Wise.} He is Most High, All- Knowing,
 Most Wise. Musnad Ash-Shihab 2 :185 . TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :360 .

£ lijj JHi HXjt f/ius We /uroe senf to yow f?iih ofOur command.} means, the Qur’an. i&H% IS SjI IX
 c} iYou knew not what is the Book, nor what is Faith.} means, ‘in the details which were given to you
 in the Qur’an.’ iBut We have made it} means, the Qur’an, Is, cs !jJ>} ia light wherewith We guide
 wlwsoever ofOur servants We will.} This is like the Ayah: p-fi tj XfX: y Xt&j ^Xfj . sxa ji 4Say: “It is
 for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And asfor those who disbelieve, there is heamness
 (deafness) in their ears, and it (the Qur'an) is blindnessfor them.”} (41:44). iAnd verily, you} means, ‘O
 Muhammad,’ iare indeed guiding to a straight path.} means, the correct behavior. Then Allah explains
 this farther by saying: 4The path ofAllSh} meaning. His Laws which He enjoins. 4 4 t* /l 4to Whom
 belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth.} means, their Lord and Sovereign, the One
 Who is controlling and ruling them, Whose decree cannot be overturned. 4S& U\$ Ji

613 Surah 42. Ash-Shura (51 - 53) (Part-25) {Verily, all matters at the end go to Allah.} means, all matters come back to Him and He issues judgement concerning them. Glorified and exalted be He far above all that the evildoers and deniers say. [

Surah 43: Az-Zukhruf

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Tafsir of SuratAz-Zukhruf

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5199–5223]

(Chapter - 43) Which was revealed in Makkah sSH ^- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. \$ t? (J==*UJ o' Lioi. 4y3 rlpjLjCs. &5 iyS" "Jj oi lij 4^0; CIS)' * .-dijr- ^5 CLCJ 13 T&Uft 41 . Ha Mini.} 42. By the manifest Book.} 43 . Verily, We have made it a Qur'an in Arabic that you may be able to understand.} 44. And verily, it is in the Mother of the Book with Us, indeed exalted, full of wisdom.} 45. Shall We then take away the Retninder from you, because you are a people excessive.} 46. And how many a Prophet have We sent amongst the mett of old.} 47. And never came there a Prophet to them but they used to mock at him.} 48. Then We destroyed men stronger (in power) than these and the example of the ancietits has passed away.} <®*r* ©*-> 4Ha-Mitn. By the manifest Book.} means, plain and clear in both wording and meaning, because it was revealed in the language of the Arabs, which is the most eloquent language for communication among people. Allah says: 4&zi

626 Tafsir Ibn Kathir i Verily, We have made it} meaning, revealed it, ia Qur'an in Arabic} meaning, in the language of the Arabs, eloquent and clear; ithat you may be able to understand.} means, that you may understand it and ponder its meanings. This is like the Ayah iln the plain Arabic language.} (26:195) iAnd verily, it is in the Mother of the Book with Us, indeed exalted, fill of wisdom.} This explains the high status of the Qur'an among the hosts on high (the angels), so that the people of earth will respect it, venerate it and obey it. }And verily, it} means, the Qur'an, VS* J 8» }is in the Mother of the Book} meaning, Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz (the Preserved Tablet). This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid.111 iO.2} iivith Us,} means, in Our presence. This was the view of Qatadah and others.,2 ' iindeed exalted} means, occupying a position of honor and virtue. This was the view of Qatadah. Ar-Razi, 27:167. Al-Baghawi 4:133. 131 At-Tabari 21 :567.

ifull of wisdom. means, clear, with no confusion or deviation. All of this indicates its noble status and virtue, as Allah says elsewhere: AU 'llUZ* \$*£3^ 4 SCjS iTI xat (this) is indeed an honorable recitation. In a Book well- guarded. Which none can touch but the pure. A revelation from the Lord of the all that exists. (56:77-80) iNay, indeed it is an admonition. So whoever wills, let him pay attention to it. (It is) in Records held (greatly) in honor, exalted, purified, in the hands of scribes (angels), honorable and obedient (80:11-16) iShall We then take away the Reminder (this Qur'an) from you, because you are a people excessive.) means, 'do you think that We will forgive you and not punish you, when you do not do as you have been commanded?' This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Abu Salih, Muj&hid and As-Suddi, and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir. iShall We then take away the Reminder (this Qur'an) from you,) Qatadah said, "By Allah, if this Qur'an had been taken away when the first generations of this Ummah rejected it, they would have been doomed, but Allah by His mercy

persisted in sending it and calling them to it for twenty years, or for as long as He willed.”² What Qatadah said is very good, and his point ' At-Jabari 21 :567, 568. ' At-Tabari 21:568.

fib 'A 0 *• ^sgSSa V.punishment.” 111 f-'.'v °thers said > “Their •-dj* *U-J ^ <J^L) lesson,” i.e., We made them a lesson for >* those disbelievers who Icame after them, that W*--' /Cv'* they would suffer the <. —ne end as them,' j±f*<.jM as in the Ayah at the end of this samh: ^ik&ZU&MU&S ** ^ . ——— i— t f.'y •> f - ' -If ^ 1 S'J-ST-^- ' ^ '* ' ... iAnd We made them a —ILJ— \ jii precedent, and an exam- %J°Jf smeratlm+ r ^ *% ^ (40<bu)a l^T^P Ip-A ^£J1Jj U }jas foem tfo way X^A'&%/'<: Ax-rff-c— of Allah in dealing with ^ VT. / '> V," ' V " ., His servants} (40:85). | ^ .5_>j 4«nd you u>i// nof find any change in the way of Allah.} (33:62) js;4 !&\$&& J&fS *£2f& Z <4& cZi&4j p& 3fHi £iVf jE. ^ (j CU .*&&^ se 4\$ lit ^ ill -15 ^ -^Vij tiilif Si tj> d! Ij L£=> Lj LJ J->W 49. And indeed ifyou ask them : “Who has created the heavens At-Tabari 21 :571

620 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr and the earth?" They will surely say: "The All-Mighty, the All-Knower created them."} 110. Who has made far you the earth like a bed, and has made far you roads therein, in order that you mayfind your way.} 111. And Wlw sends down waterfrom the sky in due measure, then We revive a dead land therewith, and even so you will be broughtforth .} H2. And Who has created all the pairs and has appointed far you ships and cattle on which you ride,} 113. In order that you may mount on their backs, and then may remember thefavor ofyour Lord when you mount thereon, and say: "Glory to Him Wlw has subjected this to us, and we could have never had it."} 114. And verily, to Our Lord we indeed are to return!"} The Idolaters' admission that Allah is the Sole Creator, and Further Evidence ofthat Allah says: If you, O Muhammad, were to ask these idolaters who associate others with Allah and worship others besides Him,' i^Jlli yfjti jii. cy} i"Wlw has created the heavens and the earth?" They will surely say: "The All-Mighty, the All-Knower created them."} In other words, they will admit that the Creator of all that is Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, yet they still worship others - idols and false gods - alongside Him. iWho has made for you the earth like a bed,} means, smooth, stable and firm, so that you can travel about in it, and stand on it and sleep and walk about, even though it is created above water, but He has strengthened it with the mountains, lest it should shake. i&Z Q>, j&3 iand has made for you roads therein,} means, paths between the mountains and the valleys.

622Surah 43 . Az-Zukhruf (9 - 14) (Part-25) 4&Q jjj*h} iin order that you may find your way.} means, in your journeys from city to city, region to region, land to land. £ ftUlf J/ iAnd Who sends down waterfrom the sky in due measure,} means, according to what is sufficient for your crops, fruits and drinking water for yourselves and your cattle. 4then We revive a dead land therewith,} means, a barren land, for when the water comes to it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth). By referring to the revival of the earth, Allah draws attention to how He will bring bodies back to life on the Day of Resurrection, after they have been dead. S&Z} iand even so you will be broughtforth.} Then Allah says: 4\$ £jl>V> s&f} 4And Who has created all the pairs} meaning, of everything that grows in the earth, all kinds of plants, crops, fruits, flowers, etc., and all different kinds ofanimals. 4^«£ ££> iattd has appointedfor you ships} or vessels, }and cattle on which you ride.} means, He has subjugated them to you and made it easy for you to eat their meat, drink their milk and ride on their backs. Allah says: iln order that you may mount on their backs,} meaning, sit comfortably and securely,

in their backs^ means, on the backs of these kinds of animals. ifeQ iand then may remember the favor of your Lord} means, whereby these animals are subjugated to you. % \lk=> Cj \m,G J>£. ^jff iwhen you mount thereon, and say: "Glory to Him Who has subjected this to us, and we could have never had it."} means, if it were not for the fact that Allah has subjugated these things to us, we could never have done this by our own strength.' Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said: "We could not have done this ourselves. iAnd verily, to Our Lord we indeed are to return .} means, *We will return to Him after our death, and our ultimate destination is with Him.' In this Ayah, mention of earthly journeys draws attention to the journey of the Hereafter, just as elsewhere, mention of earthly provision draws attention to the importance of ensuring provision for the Hereafter, as Allah says: iAnd take a provision (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is the Taqwa} (2:197). And mention of earthly garments is also used to draw attention to the raiment of the Hereafter: 4 -4"- tttydl S-Qj ^ifj} iand as an adornment; and the raiment of the Taqwa, that is better (7:26). y£; ll_j jttff J jy& 6) Of /J I jXj '•>>—• Mer-J Ji '-JjO (*^>-1 0\$ i>LvJ _/£ j jbj ijiii i>*J^ kC At-Tabari 21:576, 577.

623 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (15 -20) (Part-25 st*. jl ipu; ^ £?'^ ^ k *4 in ^ r#-£ ^ c£3' 425. Yef, they assign to some of His servants a share with Him . Verily, man is indeed a manifest ingrate!} 426. Or has He taken daughters out of what He has created, and He has selected for you sons?} 417. And if one of them is informed of the news of that which He sets forth as a parable to the Most Gracious, his face becomes dark, and he is filled with grief.} 418. A creature who is brought up in adornments, and who in dispute cannot make itself clear?} 419. And they make females the angels who themselves are servants of the Most Gracious. Did they witness their creation? Their testimony will be recorded, and they will be questioned!} 420. And they said: "If it had been the will of the Most Gracious, we should not have worshipped them." They have no knowledge whatsoever of that. They do nothing but lie!} Condemnation of the Idolaters* attribution of Offspring to Allah Here Allah speaks of the lies and fabrications of the idolaters, when they devoted some of their cattle to their false gods and some to Allah, as He described in Surat Al-An'am where He said: f. c-j & IJkijL tjILii >• tp 4 .li .1^1 4 And they assign to Allah share of the tilth and cattle which He has created, and they say: "This is for Allah" according to their claim, "and this is for our partners." But the share of their partners reaches not Allah, while the share of Allah reaches their partners! Evil is the way they judge!} (6:136). Similarly, out of the two kinds of offspring, sons and daughters, they assigned to Him the worst and least valuable (in their eyes), i.e., daughters, as Allah says:

624 Tafslr Ibn Kathir </s itfar you the males and far Him the females? That indeed is a division most unfair!} (53:21-22) And Allah says here: jjAJoj they assign to some of His servants a share with Him. Verily, man is indeed a manifest ingrate!} Then He says: H yG: ii. xm j} iOr has He taken daughters out of what He has created, and He has selected for you sons?} This is a denunciation of them in the strongest terms, as He goes on to say: tiz Ji& C (UJL1^ iAnd if one of them is informed of the news of that which he sets forth as a parable to the Most Gracious, his face becomes dark, and he is filled with grief.} means, if one of these people is given the news that there has been born to him one of those which he attributes to Allah, i.e., a daughter, he hates this news and it depresses and overwhelms him so much that he keeps away from people because he feels so ashamed. Allah says, so how can they dislike that so much and yet they attribute it to Allah? 4A creature who is brought up in adornments, and who in dispute cannot make itself clear?} means, women are regarded as lacking something, which they

make up for with jewelry and adornments from the time of childhood onwards, and when there is a dispute, they cannot speak up and defend themselves clearly, so how can this be attributed to Allah? \$£-j} iAnd they make females the angels who themselves are servants of the Most Gracious.}

625 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (15 - 20) (Part-25) means, that is what they believe about them, but Allah denounces them for that and says: \$Did they witness their creation?} meaning, did they see Allah creating them as females? }rr-^4- iTheir testimony will be recorded,} means, concerning that, iand they will be questioned!} means, about that, on the Day of Resurrection. This is a stern warning and a serious threat. JS u&&& 3 iAnd they said : "If it had been the will of the Most Gracious, we should not have worshipped them."} means, (they said:) 'if Allah had willed, He would have prevented us from worshipping these idols which are images of the angels who are the daughters of Allah; He knows about this and He approves of it.' By saying this, they combined several types of error: First: They attributed offspring to Allah - exalted and sanctified be He far above that. Second: They claimed that He chose daughters rather than sons, and they made the angels, who are the servants of the Most Gracious, female. Third: They worshipped them with no proof, evidence or permission from Allah. This was based on mere opinion, whims and desires, imitation of their elders and forefathers, and pure ignorance. They used Allah's decree as an excuse, and this reasoning betrayed their ignorance. Fourth: Allah denounced them for this in the strongest terms, for from the time He first sent Messengers and revealed Books, the command was to worship Him Alone with no partner or associate, and it was forbidden to worship anything other than Him. Allah says: Sxt Q,i» »laH ill 'jjdcl ^ ' J (. ajJj)}

626 Tafslr Ibn Kathir mm \i *>*'<. <A "' . •"-*< tvf*2.»>^>->CLJC*1?^> <3j3p^a». UuOjjU^i 1 *sf ^i«'/ > ? > i >" ^isUuiisiSoi > •''' f'V' *' i/^* i . , j^i CjJ^y \$ iajlfliC-^vj l J jVf^ iAnd verily, We have sent among every Um- mah a Messenger (pro- claiming) : "Worship Allah, and avoid all false deities." Then of them were some whom Allah guided and of them were some upon whom the straying was justified. So travel through the land and see what was

the end of those who denied.) (16:36) oj ot biiji o* &j) cfif\ */ , « Gwi q\$ iAnd ask those of Our Messengers whom We sent before you: "Did We ever appoint gods to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious?") (43:45) And Allah says in this Ayah, after mentioning this argument of theirs: i^ . In (*\$ ^) iThey have no knowledge whatsoever of that.) meaning, of the truth of what they say and the arguments they put forward. "\$} of)) iThey do nothing but lie!) means, they tell lies and fabricate untruths. 4s>£jk (U oj ^ie dJfL pj l £) iThey have no knowledge whatsoever of that. They do nothing but lie!)

627 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (21 - 25) (Part-25) Mujahid said, "They do not appreciate the power of Allah." Gifcl; XjZ-j ^ 'jlli J; .A, |*+» Jt Ujtt jfi 'j) ji £ 4 ittlj Gisji 'C Suj&j ^ tijj jibS IL JCILr _\$ j5 # qj £l \$ fcfjl; IXj il?^ Jjiil* jji l* bliili ffofoS' <* jiL-J* LIj 6 Ijlli 3^5' 4@c«.j8at 421. Or /uroe We gipen them any Book before this (the Qur'an) to which they are holding fast?} 422. Nay! They say: 'We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we guide ourselves by their footsteps."} 423. And similarly, We sent not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeed follow their footsteps."} 424. He said: "Even if I bring you better guidance than that which you found your fathers following?" They said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent."} 425. So We took revenge on them, then see what was the end of those who denied.} The Idolaters have no Proof

Allah condemns the idolaters for worshipping others instead of Allah with no evidence or proof for doing so. cf, j^? * fty 40r have We given them any Book before this} means, before their idolatry. i&fo . :• p£} 4to which they are holdingfast?} means, with regard to what they are doing. This is not the case. This is like the Ayah: * !\$? cpz%at^ iOr have We revealed to them an authority (a Scripture), m At-Tabari 21 :583.

629Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf(21 - 25) (Part-25) \$And similarly, We sent not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found ing a religion, and we will in- deed follow their footsteps.") Then He says: iSay) - ‘O Muhammad, to these idolators fLj L q Qfc f&: 4"Even if I bring you better guidance than that which you found your fathers following?" They said: "Verily, we disbe- lieve in that with which you have been sent.") ‘Even if they were convinced of the truth of what you have brought to them, they will not follow it, because of their evil intentions and their arrogance towards the truth and its people.’ £!&) 4So We took revenge on them) means, on the disbelieving nations, by inflicting various kinds of punishments, as Allah In the recitation of Hafs and Ibn ‘Amir, it is “He said” as appears in the common copy of Qur’an. The majority of the scholars of the past recited it as Ibn Kathlr mentioned it here, with the meaning “Say:” See the Tafsir of Al-Baghawi, At-Tabari , Al-W&hidi, Ibn ‘Atiyah etc nir fathers follow- certain way and /•SS .s s < s 'y.'s'X'.'x-- ' Ub jjJCL^*jvfi 1 n .4p^aljlflc£brj\jsJiiLaU bL«jtuSlj^bjJuJu Jy-D y

has described in the stories of those nations. 4then see what was the end of those who denied£ means, see what became of them, how they were destroyed and how Allah saved the believers. JjJi <£jS' lii *3/ ujjj fii&l V “ i rf r > »-' <. </ ,// ** if • ~ s-c" ir*4 tf ,s"i . •>" t Umj |^Uu> ji*} Oj} u«tU IjJji J Ay jffl jllJ, CllliJ Ail 0 £)1 OJ^y 426. And (remember) when Ibrahim said to his father and his people: "Verily, I am innocent ofwhat you worship,"} 427. "Except Him Who created me; and verily, He will guide me."} 428. And he made it a word lasting among his offspring, that they may turn back.} 429. Nay, but I gave to these and their fathers to enjoy, till there came to them the truth, and a Messenger making things clear.} 430. And when the truth came to them, they said: "This is magic, and we disbelieve therein."} 431. And they say: "Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the two towns?"} 432. Is it they who would portion out the mercy ofyour Lord? It is We Who portion out between them their livelihood in this world, and We raised some of them above others in ranks, so that some may employ others in their work. But the mercy of your Lord is better than what they amass.}

433. And were it not that mankind would have become of one community, We would have providedfor those who disbelieve in the Most Gracious, silver roofs for their houses, and elevators whereby they ascend,} 434. And for their houses, doors, and thrones on which they could recline,} 435. And adornments of gold. Yet all this would have been nothing but an enjoyment of this world. And the Hereafter with your Lord isfor those who have Taqwa.} Ibrahim's Declaration of Tawhid• Here Allah tells us about His servant, Messenger and close Friend, the leader of the monotheists and the father of all subsequent Prophets, from whom Quraysh were descended and claimed to have taken their religion. He disowned his father's and his people's worship of idols and said: 4“Verily, I am innocent ofwhat you worship, except Him Who created me; and verily. He will guide me.” And he made it a Word lasting among his offspring,} The Word means the worship of Allah Alone with no partner or associate, and the denunciation of all gods apart from Him, i.e.. La. ilaha Ulalldh. He left this word as an example to be

followed by those of his progeny who were guided by Allah. 4that they may turn back.} means, come back to this word. Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others commented on the Ayah: 4 mC 4And he made it a Word lasting among his offspring,} “This means, La ilaha Ulalldh, and there are still those among his offspring who say it.” ' A similar view was narrated from Ul At-Tabari 21 :589.

633 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (26 - 35) (Part-25) Al-Qurazi, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd . * 11 Several scholars of Tafsir stated that by this, the Quraysh meant Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlrah and ‘Urwah bin Mas*ud Ath- Thaqafi. The apparent meaning is that what they meant was a great man from either of the two towns. Allah responded to their rejection by saying: 4<^J 54-r5; 4Is it they who would portion out the mercy of your Lord?) meaning, the matter has nothing to do with them; it is for Allah to decide. Allah knows best where to direct His Message, and He does not reveal it except to the one who is the purest in heart and soul, and of the noblest descent. Then Allah points out that He differentiates among His creation in terms of what He gives them of wealth, provision, intellect, understanding and other visible and hidden strengths: ilt is We Who portion out between them their livelihood in this world,) iso that some may employ others in their work.) It was said that this means that some employ others in their work, because one needs the other, and vice versa. This was the view of As-Suddi and others . *21 if V A*-i> **^ 4But the mercy of your Lord is better than which they amass.) means, the mercy of Allah towards His creation is better for them than the wealth and conveniences of this world which they possess. Wealth is not a Sign of Divine Pleasure 4iU* £1 3jZ ol t&) At-Tabari 21 :592, 593. 121 At-Tabari 21 :595.

•»U Ljla U y>j ££» jbl x* jjJ CaJl j! jJ» «// f/n's world were worth a gnat's wing before Allah, He would not give a disbeliever a drink of water.^ Al-Baghawi narrated its chain of narration.121 ^UuLjJ ii\ij JCjt iAnd the Hereafter with your Lord is (only) for those who have Taqiva.^ means, it is exclusively for them, and no one else will share it with them. When ‘Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, visited the Messenger of Allah in seclusion, when he was keeping away from his wives, and he saw him resting on a rough mat which had left marks on his side, his eyes filled with tears and he said, “O Messenger of Allah, look at this Chosroes and this Caesar with all that they have, and you are the best of Allah’s creation.” The Messenger of Allah jg was reclining, but he sat up and said: j,\ u oil si j\ •Are you in doubt, O son of Al-Khattab?» Then he jg said: •uioJi ^ iSZJ- fclhJj(i •Those are people for whom the enjoyments are hastened in this world.^ According to another report: •Does it not please you that this world is for them and the Hereafter is for In as the Two Sahihs and elsewhere, it is reported that the Messenger of Allah \$)& said: IM (3) CjJI At-Tirmidhi 6:611. Al-Baghawi 4 :138 . Similar was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and other. Muslim 2 :113. Muslim 2:110.

636 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir aDo not drink from vessels of gold and silver, and do not eat from plates of the same, for these things are for them in this world and for us in the Hereafter.s11 Allah has granted these things to them in this world because it is insignificant, as was reported by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah via Abu Hazim from Sahl bin Sa’d, who said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said: «// this world were worth a gnat's wing before Allah, He would never give a disbeliever a drink of waterJ” At-Tirmidhi said: “Hasan Sahth.” Of (»r^> 'Qr'J-j £ J+* fri Of- u-*i O'r jir?. oJLj jli tit li[Jj»- ^ 4^^ h ^ JL Jiyaji l*U 4 OfJ <£-Zf \$ i-i)' 4^ cfjt ^cyjjju; jr^b ^ 4'j-icj 4^4' j? .A, o; tiy ji-j opj <aU I J>y* > i>f* Oi &-J C£ isl£»

436. And whosoever Ya'shu (turns away blindly) from the remembrance of the Most Gracious, We appoint for him Shaytan to be a Qarin (a companion) to him.) 437. And verily, they hinder them from the path, but they think that they are guided aright!} 436. Till, when (such a one) comes to Us, he says, "Would that between me and you were the distance of 0k two easts (or the east and west) a worst companion (indeed)!"} 439. It will profit you not this Day as you did wrong, (and) that you will be sharers in the punishment.} 440. Can you make the deaf to hear, or can you guide the blind |i| Fath Al-Bari9:465, Muslim 3 : 1637

637 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (36 - 45) (Part-25) or him who is in manifest error?) 441 . And even if We take you away, We shall indeed take vengeance on them.) 442. Or (if) We show you that wherewith We threaten them, then verily, We have perfect command over them.) 443. So hold you fast to that which is revealed to you. Verily, you are on the straight path.) 444. And verily, this is indeed a Dhikr for you and your people, and you will be questioned.) 445. And ask whom We sent before you of Our Messengers: "Did We ever appoint gods to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious?" The Shaytdn is the Companion of the One Who turns away from Ar-Rahman 4 And whosoever Ya'shu (turns away blindly) means, whoever willfully ignores and turns away 4 from the remembrance of the Most Gracious,) Al-'Ashd (the root of Ya'sh) refers to weakness of vision; what is meant here is weakness of insight. 4 We appoint for him Shaytdn to be a Qarin (a companion) to him.) This is like the Ayat. a 3? u k spy.#3x) 4 And whoever contradicts and opposes the Messenger after the right path has been shown clearly to him) (4:1 15), 4 So when they turned away, Allah turned their hearts away) (61:5), and

639 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (36 - 45) (Part-25) Allah's Vengeance upon the Enemies of His Messenger § will surely come to pass Allah further says: 4 And even if We take you away, We shall indeed take vengeance on them means, *We will inevitably wreak vengeance upon them and punish them, even if you pass away.' pffa Cji '\$> \$} 40r (if) We show you that wherewith We threaten them, then verily. We have perfect command over them.) means, We are able to do both,' but Allah will not take His Messenger jg (in death) until He gives him the joy of seeing his enemies brought low and gives him power and authority over them and their wealth. This was the view of As-Suddi and was the opinion favored by Ibn Jarir.*

Encouragement to adhere to the Qur'an

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5223-5233]

Allah then says; 4 So hold you fast to that which is revealed to you. Verily, you are on the straight path.} means, hold fast to the Qur'an which has been sent down to your heart, for it is truth and what it leads to is truth that shows the way to the straight path that leads to Gardens of Delight and eternal, everlasting goodness. 3% 4 And verily, this is a Dhikr far you and your people,} It was said that this means, 'it is an honor for you and your people;' this was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd.*2 This means that it is an honor for them in that it was At-Jabari 21 :609. At-Jabari 21:610, 611.

J liass® nr ^- c' *4- ?- Vj3 lij \$PL> ,f-M *1 ..!'• '-lIXIM 1'^? >>&' ^ j» (;l) LL-jf dLilj) (Oii [^] iuS (And ask those whom We sent before you of Our Messengers.) 11 ' This was narrated by Qatadah, Ad-

Dahhak and As-Suddi from Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him.' 2 ' Yet this appears to be an explanation rather than an alternate version of recitation. And Allah knows best. 4 && 4i .^pj & \$g&£if oj jji; c;j 1k0£t £ { iS). Jt i-jl. J* j+ij Jx£ pc- Hj ijluJ lH ja;LJl *fdim IjJllj ps'jjpj; jh4*1 y'jjjt Lfii-1 j» £ >'h v<aipazra (\$\$>&& & LijAJ-l*liJa^ tlnS.ySl^ 'j&Ktr&Z \$ (\$i Ojdd&ijfj'&y •£v A/* /• - / ->»,> 446. And indeed We did send Musa with Our Ayat to Fir'awn and his chiefs. He said: "Verily, I am a Messenger of the Lord of all that exists."} 447. But when he came to them with Our Ayat, behold, they laughed at them}. 448. And not an Ayah We showed them but it was greater than its fellow preceding it, and We seized them with torment, in order that they might turn.} At-Tabari 2 1 :611. At-Tabari 21 :611, 612.

449. And they said (to Musa): "O you sorcerer! Invoke your Lord for us according to what He has made a pact with you. Verily, We shall guide ourselves."} 450. But when We removed the torment from them, behold, they broke their covenant.} Musa was sent with the Message of Tawhid to Fir'awn and His Chiefs Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Musa, peace be upon him, and how He sent him to Fir'awn and his chiefs. That is, his governors, ministers, leaders and followers among the Egyptians and the Children of Israel. Allah sent him to call them to worship Allah alone, with no partner or associate, and to forbid them from worshipping anything other than Him. He sent him with mighty signs, such as his hand and his staff, other signs such as the flood, locusts, Qummal, frogs and blood, and the loss of their crops and lives. Yet despite all that they remained arrogant and stubbornly refused to follow him; they rejected his message and made fun of it, and laughed at the onewho had brought it. feli * ji *1& 4And not an Ayah We showed them but it was greater than its fellow preceding it,} but despite that they would not give up their sin, misguidance, ignorance and confusion. Every time one of these signs came to them, they would go and implore Musa, saying, 4j*& '&> 4"0 you sorcerer!..."} meaning, expert or knowledgeable one - this was the view of Ibn Jarir. [21 The scholars of that time were the sorcerers or magicians, and magic was not regarded as something reprehensible by them at that time, so this was not a slight on their part. They were in a state of need, so it would not have been appropriate for See the discussion of these events in volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ar'af[7 :133],2] At-Jabari 21 :615.

643Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (51 - 56) (Part-25) them to insult him. This was a way of honoring him, as they thought. On each occasion, they promised Musa that if the torment was lifted from them, they would believe in him and let the Children of Israel go with him, but on each occasion they went back on their word. This is like the Ayat Cj f&z *4: flit; jiiiii; :(p'j &Ji\ (L\$} oJ Sie ip li IjSli C3j uli & iiK" <•&* pi ^ A s?i 4So We sent on them : the flood, the locusts, the Qummal, the frogs, and the blood; manifest signs, yet they remained arrogant, and they were of those people who were criminals. And when the punishment struck them, they said: "O Musa! Invoke your Lord for us because of His promise to you. If you remove the punishment from us, we indeed shall believe in you, and we shall let the Children of Israel go with you." But when We removed the punishment from them to a fixed term, which they had to reach, behold! they broke their word!} (7:133-135) xff or. 4 4&A &'&} 4&Z 1\$ ovj j* tfj' tii oj 5@ i*ji <<>.: ..S it jl »y4 Ijil ii-u liiit tjill; liJi Cj <51. And Fir'awn proclaimed among his people (saying) : "O my people! Is not mine the dominion of Egypt, and these rivers flowing underneath me. See you not then?"} 452. "Am I not better than this one (Musa) who is despicable and can scarcely express himself clearly?"} 453. Why then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him, or angels sent along with

him?"} 454. Thus he fooled his people, and they obeyed him. Verily, they were ever a people who were rebellious.} 455. So when they angered Us, We punished them, and

644 Tafstr Ibn Kathir drowned them all.} 456. And We made them a precedent, and an example to later generations.} Fir'awn's Address to His People and how Allah punished Him Allah tells us how Fir'awn stubbornly persisted in his rebellion and disbelief. He assembled his people and addressed them in a vainglorious fashion, boasting of his dominion over Egypt. 4Is not mine the dominion of Egypt, and these rivers flowing underneath me?} Qatadah said, "They had gardens and rivers of flowing water."111 4 \$&} 4See you not then?} means, 'do you not see my position of might and power?' - implying that Musa and his followers were poor and weak. This is like the Ayah 4Then he gathered (his people) and cried aloud, saying "I am your lord, most high." So Allah seized him with punishment for his last and first transgression.} (79:23-25) 4^> rfjll&£% f} 4Am I not better than this one who is despicable} As-Suddi said, "He was saying, indeed I sun better than this one, who is despicable'."21 Some of the grammarians of Basrah'3 ' said that Fir'awn - may the curse of Allah be upon him - was saying that he was better than MQsa, peace be upon him. But this is an obvious lie, may continued curses be upon him until the Day of Resurrection. By describing MUd as despicable he meant - as Sufyan said - insignificant. Qatadah and As-Suddi said, "He meant, weak." Ibn Jarir said, 111 At-Tabari 21:616. At-Tabari 21 :616. I3 ' At-Tabari 21:617.

645 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (51 - 56) (Part-25) "He meant, he had no power, authority or wealth." iand can scarcely express himself clearly} means, he cannot speak clearly, he stammers and cannot speak well. Fir'awn's description of Musa as "despicable" is a lie; rather it is he who was despicable and insignificant, lacking in physical, moral and religious terms, and it is Musa who was noble, truthful, righteous and upright. iand can scarcely express himself clearly}. This was also a lie. Although something happened to Mflsa's tongue when he was a child, when it was burnt by a coal. He asked Allah to loosen the knot from his tongue (i.e., to correct his speech defect) so that they could understand what he said, and Allah had answered his prayer and said: iYou are granted your request, O Musa} (20:36). It may be the case that some problem remained which he had not asked to be relieved of, as Al-Hasan Al-Basri suggested, and that he had asked only to be relieved of that which stood in the way of his conveying the Message. A person cannot be blamed for physical matters over which he has no control. Even though Fir'awn had the intelligence to understand that, he wanted to confuse and mislead his people, who were ignorant and stupid. So he said: ty#} iWhy then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him...?} meaning, adornments which are placed on the arms. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Qatadah and others.! 1 ! '^3 \$ } } ior angels sent along with him?} meaning, to serve him and to testify that he is telling the truth. He looked only at outward m At-Tabari 21 :619.

appearances and did not understand the true inner matters that are clearer than what he focused on, if only he had understood that. Allah says: 4Thus he fooled his people, and they obeyed him.} meaning, he confused them and invited them to misguidance, and they responded to him. iVerily, they were ever a people who were rebellious.} Then Allah says: 4So when they angered Us, We punished them, and drowned them all.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said it means: "When they angered Us means, they provoked Our wrath."111 Ad-Dahhak said, it means "They made Us angry." This was also the view of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad

bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Qatadah, As-Suddi and other scholars of TafsirP^ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that *Uqbah bin ‘Amir, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said: iiUS U juUI iiji5 2ii cjjf lij» aJo *When you see that Allah gives a person what he wants even though he is persisting in sin, that means that Allah is enticing him into destruction .» Then he recited: lHiit 'Ctyiy* \Lj*} 4So when they angered Us, We punished them, and drowned them all.}13 At-Tabari 21:622. At-Tabari 2 1 :622 ; Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :383 Ahmad 4 :145, with slight differences.

648 TafsTr Ibn Kathir who come after them.” Allah is the One Who guides to the straight path, and unto Him is the final return. k J* Ji*- IjSljj K-t)j[llii &i&Z&CZi&JlZ o' p > j; -*ja ijfr <h £\la pj ffy J0 4 & P ft to P&. % & lt& *k isj' ufoAt js iis ijArjC ,^1*6 jC. Oj #£*£2 !>, c&to#2 j;A it k St \$£& Sj&2 Si lA_Si 'ZZt-M Jjy 1*^ . Si J£i1i 457. And when the son of Maryam is quoted as an example, behold, your people cry aloud thereat.) 458. And say : "Are our gods better or is he?" They quoted not the above example except for argument. Nay! But they are a quarrelsome people.) 459. He was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor to him, and We made him an example for the Children of Israel.) 460. And if it were Our will. We would have made angels to replace you on the earth.) 461. And he shall be a known sign for (the coming of) the Hour. Therefore have no doubt concerning it. And follow Me! This is the straight path.) 462. And let not Shaytan hinder you. Verily, he (Shaytan) to you is a plain enemy.) 463. And when ‘Isa came with clear proofs, he said: "I have come to you with Al-HikmahJ and in order to make clear to you some of that in which you differ. Therefore have Taqwa of Allah and obey me.") 464. "Verily, Allah! He is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him. This is the straight path.") 465. But the sects from among themselves differed. So woe to ^ At-Tabari 21 :624, Al-Qurtubi 16:102. * See the Tafsir of Surah Sdd (38 :20)

those who do wrongfrom the torment ofa painful Day!} The Contempt of the Quraysh for the son of Maryam, and His true Status with Allah Allah tells us how the Quraysh persisted in their disbelief and stubborn arguments: 4And when the son of Maryam is quoted as an example, behold, your people cry aloud thereat.} Several others narrated that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, As-Suddi and Ad-Dahhak said, “They laughed, i.e., they were astounded by that.” * Qatadah said, “They were repelled by that and they laughed.”*21 Ibrahim An-Nakha‘i said, “They turned away.”*31

The reason for this was mentioned by Muhammad bin Ishaq

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5233–5245]

in As-Sirah. He said, “According to what I have heard, the Messenger of Allah 5^5 sat down one day with Al-Walld bin Al- Mughlrah in the Masjid, and An-Nadr bin Al-Harith came and sat down with them. There were also other men from the Quraysh in the gathering. The Messenger of Allah jg spoke, then An-Nadr bin Al-Harith came up to him and the Messenger of Allah ag spoke to him until he sg defeated him in argument. Then he sg recited to him and to them, „<IT 4Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} (21 :98) Then the Messenger of Allah 3g got up and went to sit with ‘Abdullah bin Al-Zab‘ari At-Tamlmi. Al-Walld bin Al-Mughlrah said to him, ‘By Allah, An-Nadr bin Al-Harith could not match the son of ‘Abd Al-Muttalib in argument. Muhammad claims that we and these gods that we worship are fuel for Hell.’

‘Abdullah bin Az-Zab‘ari said, *By Allah, if I meet with him I 111 Al-Qurtubi 16:103. *21 At-Tabari 21 :627. *31 Al-Qurtubi, 16:103.

meaning, they take this argument as a basis for rejecting your message. Then Allah mentions Isa bin Maryam and says: <(He was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor to him, and We made him an example for the Children of Israel. And if it were Our will. We would have made angels to replace you on the earth. And he (Isa) shall be a known sign for the Hour.) meaning, the miracles and signs that happened at his hands, such as raising the dead and healing the sick, are sufficient as signs of the approach of the Hour. iTherefore have no doubt concerning it. And follow Me! This is the straight path}.’^ Ibn Jarir mentioned that Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on the Ayah: iAnd when the son of Maryam is quoted as an example, behold, your people cry aloud thereat.} “This means the Quraysh, when it was said to them: > -r »> * < \ " 5 1 v 4 Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fitel for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} (21:98) The Quraysh said to him: “What about Isa bin Maryam?” He said: I* o ^ , ' l f ji»l -Up Jli «He is the servant and Messenger of Allah. They said, *By Allah, he means that we should take him as a lord just as the Christians took Isa son of Maryam as a lord.’ 111 Ibn Hishdm 1:396-398.

Then Allah said: fa s \$ tJi/* c} iThey quoted not the above example exceptfor argument. Nay! But they are a quarrelsome people iAnd say : “Are our gods better or is he?”}. Qatadah said, “They were saying, ‘our gods are better than him’.” Qatadah said; “Ibn Mas‘ud, may Allah be pleased with him, recited it (Are our gods better or is this (person)?)” they mean Muhammad ^a i&s. c} iThey quoted not the above example exceptfor argument.} means, for the sake of stubborn argument, for they knew that he (Isa) was not included in the Ayah (21:98), because that would not make sense. The words, > ' >> Oi iCertainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell!} (21:98) are addressed to the Quraysh, for they used to worship idols and false gods - they did not worship the Messiah so why should he be included in what the Ayah says? What they said was only for the sake of argument; they did not really believe in it. Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded that Abu Umamah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah said: «No people go astray after having been guided, but they resort to (futile) argument .» (i) At-Tabari 21 :625. There are similar authentic narrations: Mushkil Al-Ath&r 1 :431 , and Al-Hakim 2 :385.

653 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (57 - 65) (Part-25) Then the Messenger of Allah \$£5 recited this Ayah 477iey quoted not the above example except for argument. Nay! But they are a quarrelsome people It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah and Ibn Jarir. At-Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Hasan Sahih, we do not know it except from the Hadith of Hajjaj bin Dinar...”121 xl ji 51^ 4He (‘Isa) was not more than a servant. We granted Our favor to him,} means, Isa, peace be upon him; he was no more than one of the servants of Allah whom Allah blessed with prophethood and messengership. i&i&l X0, iand We made him an example for the Children of Israel.} means, ‘a sign, proof and evidence of Our power to do whatever We will.’ uj'fi' S. . itli %>} iAnd if it were Our will, We would have made angels to replace you on the earth.} As-Suddi said, “They would have taken your place on (the earth).”13 ' Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and Qatadah said, “They would have succeeded one another just as you succeed one another.”14 This view is implied by the former vei w. Mujahid said, “They would have

populated the earth instead of you.”⁵ Allah’s saying: Ahmad 5:256. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :130 ; Ibn Majah 1:19, At-Jabari 2 1 :629 131 At-Jabari 21:631. At-Jabari 21 :630. 151 At-Tabari 21 :630.

4And he (‘Isa) shall be a known sign for (the coming of) the Hour The correct view concerning this phrase is that it refers to his descent before the Day of Resurrection, as Allah says: ‘it *1^1’ lb o\j} 4And there is none of the People of the Scripture but must believe in him before his death> (4:159). - meaning before the death of Isa, peace be upon him - (IjjJ6 oj\$2 f&if 'fff} 4And on the Day of Resurrection, he will be a witness against them (4:159). This meaning has the support from an alternate recitation of the Ayat; (ULUJ pjj (And he shall be a known sign for (the coming of) the Hour.) means, evidence that the Hour will surely come. Mujahid said: 4And he shall be a sign for (the coming of) the Hour.} means, sign and “One of the signs of the Hour will be the appearance of ‘Isa son of Maryam before the Day of Resurrection.”¹¹ Something similar was also narrated from Abu Hurayrah, Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Abu Malik, ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and others.¹² Many Mutaw&tir Hadiths report that the Messenger of Allah said that Isa will descend before the Day of Resurrection as a just ruler and fair judge. iTherefore have no doubt concerning it.} means, do not doubt that it will surely come to pass. 4Andfollow Me.} means, ‘in what I tell you about it.’ At-Jabari 21 :632. At-Jabari 21 :632 ; Al-Qurtubi 16:106.

655Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf(57 - 65) (Part-25 iW* piJZ 'iS 477n's is f/te straight path. And let not Shaytan hinder you.} means, from following the truth. iVerily, he (Satan) to you is a plain enemy. And when 'Isa came with (Our) clear proofs, he said: "I have come to you with AI-Hikmah.. ."} , meaning prophethood: 4 (/_<<*< iand in order to make clear to you some of the (points) in which you differ.} Ibn Jarir said, “This means religious matters, not worldly matters.” 11 * What he said is good. 4ill 4Therefore have Taqwa of Allah} means, ‘with regard to what I command you to do.’ iand obey me.} means, “in what I bring to you.’ iVerily, Allah! He is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him. This is the straight path.} means, *you and I are enslaved to Him, in need of Him and we commonly share in the worship of Him Alone, associating none with Him.’ iThis is the straight path} means, “what I have brought to you is the straight path, which is the worship of the Lord, may He exalted, Alone.’ U &&} iBut the sectsfrom among themselves differed.} m At-Tabari 2 1 :635

657Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf(66 - 73) ((Part-25) Messengers wait’ iiu 4on/yybr the Hour that it shall come upon them suddenly while they perceive not?} means, for it is real and will inevitably come to pass, and these negligent people are unprepared for it. When it comes, it will catch them unawares, and on that Day they will feel the utmost regret when regret will not benefit them in the slightest and will not afford them any protection. 4Friends on that Day will be foes one to another except those who have Taqwa.} means, every friendship that exists for a purpose other than for the sake of Allah will turn to enmity on the Day of Resurrection, except for that which is for the sake of Allah, which will last forever. This is like the statement of Ibrahim, peace be upon him, to his people: J&~i i ^ tijJ' <4 'XA jif o_>j ji cA p Uj jUli iYou have taken (for worship) idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you shall have no helper.} (29:25) Good News for Those with Taqwa on the Day of Resurrection, and Their entry into Paradise £*> 4My servants! No fear shall be on you this Day, nor shall you grieve.} Then He will give them the glad tidings: 1 \yjXt

4(You) who believed in Our Aydt and were Muslims.} means, their hearts believed and they submitted inwardly and outwardly to the Laws of Allah. Al-Mu'tamir bin Sulayman narrated that his father said: "When the Day of Resurrection comes and the people are resurrected, there will be no one left who will not be filled with terror. Then a caller will cry out: && 4My servants! No fear shall be on you this Day , nor shall you grieve.} So all the people will be filled with hope, but this will be followed by the words: ip; *&} 4(You) who believed in Our Aydt and were Muslims.} Then all of mankind will be filled with despair apart from the believers."111 4Z£\ \}U\} iEnter Paradise,} means, they will be told to enter Paradise. ^} iyou and your wives,} means, your counterparts 4in happiness (Tulibarun).} means, in delight and joy.12' iTrays ofgold and cups will be passed round them;} means, fine vessels of gold containing food and drink, without spouts or handles. 111 At-Tabari 21 :639. * This phrase Tuhbarun has already been mentioned in SuratAr-Rum [30 : 1 5] where there was a narration stating that it means, "Luxury." Ibn Kathlr's view is that it is more general than that, as seen by his comment here

[(there will be) therein all that their souls could desire).] Some of them recited: iJiSft t) 4that their souls desire,) iand all that eyes could delight in) means, of good food, delightful fragrances and beautiful scenes. iand you will therein) means, in Paradise iabide forever) means, you will never leave it or want to exchange it. Then it will be said to them, as a reminder of the blessing and favor of Allah: 6iij) iThis is the Paradise, which you have been made to inherit because ofyour deeds that you used to do.) means, the righteous deeds which were the cause of your being included in the mercy of Allah. For no one will be admitted to Paradise by virtue of their deeds alone; that will be by the mercy and grace of Allah. But the varying ranks and degrees of Paradise will be attained according to one's righteous deeds. iTherein for you will be fruits in plenty,) means, of all kinds. i'oM ioofwhich you will eat.) means, whatever you choose and desire. When food and drink are mentioned, fruit is also mentioned to complete the picture of blessing and joy. And Allah knows best.

661Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf(74 - 80) (Part-25) The Punishment ofthe Doomed

The description of the state of the blessed is followed by a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5245–5252]

description of the state of the doomed. iVerily, the criminals will be in the torment of Hell to abide therein forever. It will not be lightenedfor them,} meaning, not even for one moment. 4&£ 4and they will be plunged into destruction with deep regrets, sorrows and in despair therein,} means, they will despair ofany goodness. Cj} 4We wronged them not, but they were the wrongdoers.} means, by their committing wrong actions after proof had been established against them and Messengers had been sent to them, but they rejected them and rebelled, so they are to be punished accordingly. And your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) servants. AAnd they will cry: "O Malik..."} who is the keeper of Hell. Al-Bukhari said, "Hajjaj bin Minhal told us, Sufyan bin TJaynah told us, from 'Amr bin 'Ata,' from Safwan bin Yala that his father, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah jg reciting on the Minbar. 4^j uiAi } AAnd they will cry : "O Malik! Let your Lord make an end of u\$."} W meaning, let Him destroy our souls and give us some respite from our predicament.' But it will be as Allah says: 111 Fath Al-Bari, 8 :43 1

4Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die nor shall its torment be lightened for them) (35:36). 'M& && iBut it will be avoided by the wretched, who will enter the great Fire. There he will neither die (to be in rest) nor live (a good living).) (87:11-13). When they ask to be allowed to die, Malik will answer them: 4He will say: "Verily, you shall abide forever.") meaning, "you will have no way out from it and no refuge.' Then the reason why they are doomed will be given, which is their stubborn resistance to the truth. Allah says: ^Indeed We have brought the truth to you,) meaning, "We have explained it to you clearly and in detail.' i&fr& ibut most of you have a hatred for the truth.) means, *but your nature could not accept it and did not seek it; on the contrary, you followed and venerated falsehood, and you stood in the way of truth and refused it, and despised its followers.' So they will blame themselves and will feel regret at the time when regret will not be of any benefit to them. Then Allah says: % (A 'JA iOr have they plotted some plan? Then We too are planning.) Mujahid said, "They wanted to plot some evil, but We are also planning." 111 What Mujahid said is like the Ayah: ^ <J=i Jf&) 4So they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not.) (27:50). The idolators were hying their utmost to find ways of refuting m Al-Tabari 21 :146.

the truth with falsehood, but Allah planned it so that the consequences of that would backfire on them. He said in refutation: (*\n 1 V Cl <Or do they think that We hear not their secrets and their private counsel?} meaning, what they say secretly and openly. i*P tiia &} <Ves (We do) and Our messengers are by them, to record.} means, "We know what they are doing, and the angels are also recording their deeds, major and minor.' <21 *5 263 3»J^ 4 P \$2 && pp *3* tS JC ^ .fit H'Cj Oiijt p ^-:Vt dS * -Ji iiliT oj <s>s v; 4; *ast jju 4@SP?3p i*j jp giB ip3P St*2 <81. Say, "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of the worshippers."} <82. Glorified is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, the Lord of the Throne! Exalted be Hefrom all that they ascribe (to Him).} <83. So leave them (alone) to speak nonsense and play until they meet the Day of theirs which they have been promised.} <84. It is He Who is the only God in the heaven and the only God on the earth. And He is the All-Wise, the All-Knower.} 485. And Blessed be He to Whom belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, and with Whom is the knowledge of the Hour, and to Whom you (all) will be returned.} <86. And those whom they invoke instead of Him have no power of intercession - except for those who bear witness to the truth knowingly, and they know.}

487. And if you ask them who created them, they will surely say: "Allah." How then are they turned away?} 488. And his saying: "O my Lord! Verily, these are a people who believe not!"} 489. So turn away from them, and say: Salam (peace!) But they will come to know.} Allah has no Offspring Allah says: 4ji> 4Say} - 'O Muhammad' - 4k&\$\$ tfc% cpA& o\} 4If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of the worshippers.} meaning, *if this were so, then I would worship Him on that basis, because I am one of His servants; I obey all that He commands me and I am not too arrogant or proud to worship Him.' This conditional phrase does not mean that what is described could happen nor that is possible as Allah says: * j sit 4Had Allah willed to take a son, He could have chosen whom He willed out of those whom He created. But glory be to Him! He is Allah, the One, the Irresistible.} (39:4). Allah says here: 4Glorified is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, the Lord of the Throne! Exalted be Hefrom all that they ascribe (to Him).} meaning, exalted and sanctified and glorified be the Creator of all things far above having any offspring, for He is Unique, One and Eternally Self-Sufficient. There is none equal to Him or like Him, and He does not have any offspring.

4 So leave them (alone) to speak nonsense means, in their ignorance and misguidance, and play in their world, which is the Day of Resurrection, i.e., then they will come to know what their end and destination will be on that Day. The Uniqueness of the Lord means, He is the God of those who are in the heavens and the God of those who are on earth; all of them worship Him and are humbled before Him. And He is the All-Wise, the All-Knower. This Ayah is like the Ayah: U pMj fiZ cffft jj j ilf £> } iAnd He is Allah in the heavens and on the earth; He knows what you conceal and what you reveal, and He knows what you earn. (6:3) which means, He is the One who is called Allah in the heavens and on the earth. Cj jfji'j ^ 'A \$j£J } iAnd Blessed be He to Whom belongs the kingdom of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, means, He is their Creator and Sovereign, the One Who is controlling them with none to resist or oppose His rule. Blessed and exalted be He far above the notion of His having a child. He is eternally free of all faults and shortcomings.

667 Surah 43. Az-Zukhruf (81 - 89) (Part-25) things and He has no partner in that. Yet despite that they still worship others alongside Him who have nothing and are able to do nothing. This is the utmost foolishness and stupidity. Allah says: iHow then are they turned away?} The Prophet's Complaint to Allah iAnd his saying: "O my Lord! Verily, these are a people who believe not!" means, Muhammad jg said this; he complained to his Lord about his people who did not believe in him, and said, 'O Lord, these people do not believe.' This is like the Ayah: seat wa& k *3 & } iAnd the Messenger will say: "O my Lord! Verily, my people deserted this Qur'an." (25 :30). This is the view of Ibn MasTld, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujfihid and Qatadah, and this is how Ibn Jarir interpreted it.¹¹¹ Al-Bukhari said: "Abdullah - meaning Ibn Mas*Qd, may Allah be pleased with him - recited (Ayah 88 of Az-Zukhrufj: (i —<j \j Jlij) (And the Messenger will say: "O my Lord!")¹²¹ Muj&hid said concerning the Ayah: ^ fji tifi* {>1 iAnd his saying : "O my Lord! Verily, these are a people who believe not!"} "Allah is stating what Muhammad gj said."¹³¹ Qatadah said, "These are the words of your Prophet jg, when he complained At-Tabari 21 :656. ¹²¹ Path Al-B&ri, 8:431. At-Tabari 21:656.

668 Tafslr IbtI Kathir about his people to his Lord." iSo turn away from them,} means, from the idolators. and say Salam (peace!)} means, 'do not respond to them in the same evil manner in which they address you; but try to soften their hearts and forgive them in word and deed.' Sy-> } iBut they will come to know.} This is a warning from Allah for them. His punishment, which cannot be warded off, struck them, and His religion and His word was supreme. Subsequently Jihad and striving were prescribed until the people entered the religion of Allah in crowds, and Islam spread throughout the east and the west. And Allah knows best.

Surah 44: Ad-Dukhan

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Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5253–5282]

In Musnad Al-Bazzar, it is recorded from Abu At-Tufayl ‘Amir bin Wathilah from Zayd bin Harithah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to Ibn Sayyad: *ui b- ikJ.Z Ji» «/ am concealing something, what is if?® And the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was concealing Surat Ad-Dukhan from him. He (Ibn Sayyad) said: “It is Ad-Dukh.” The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said. Sat U Lils iBe off with you! Whatever Allah wills happens, a*1 P *— In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. At-TabarSni , 5:88, there is a deficiency in the reporting of this text. The story of Ibn Sayyad was recorded by Al-Bukhari, no. 1354 , and Muslim no. 7345, but there is no mention of the Surah in question. There are a number of possible explanations for the Hadith besides referring to this Surah, See Fath Al-B&rino . 3055*

jjjj UJ jill 4 i£J>l 15^ <^£=3, S & iri i*-»IJ ^ £(liJJJ; ji [f ij^>^- jA (X ^ Si A V ^ 0< fc&£ ^Vfj yj S^uii ^@/<£«iSVi v>ij Ha Mint .) 42. By the manifest Book that makes things clear. 43. We serif if down on a blessed night. Verily, We are ever warning.) 44. Therein (that night) is decreed every matter, Hakim.) 45. As a command from Us. Verily, We are ever sending,) 46. (As) a mercy from your Lord. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.) 47. The Lord of the heavens and the earth and all that is between them, if you (but) have a faith with certainty.) 48. LS ilaha illa Huwa. He gives life and causes death - your Lord and the Lord of your forefathers.) The Qur'an was revealed on Laylatul-Qadr AMh tells us that He revealed the Magnificent Qur'an on a blessed night, Laylatul-Qadr (the Night of Decree), as He says elsewhere: 4Verify, We have sent it down in the Night of Al-Qadr) (97:1). This was in the month of Ramadan, as Allah tells us: 4it:jiif 44 ai(5i35 %.) 4The month of Ramadan in which was revealed the Qur'Sn) (2:185). We have already quoted the relevant Hadiths in (the Tafsir of) Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat them here. 4^%& 4Verily, We are ever warning.) means, telling them what is good for them and what is harmful for them, according to SharTah, so*

that the proof of Allah may be established against His servants. 4Therein (that night) is decreed every matter, Hakim.} means, on Laylatul-Qadr, the decrees are transferred from Al- Lawh Al-Mahfuz to the (angelic) scribes who write down the decrees of the (coming) year including life span, provision, and what will happen until the end of the year. This was narrated from Ibn TJmar, Mujahid, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak and others among the Sa/a/ iHakim} means decided or confirmed, which cannot be changed or altered. Allah says: 4"^\ It\$¥ 4As a command from Us.} meaning, everything that happens and is decreed by Allah and the revelation that He sends down - it all happens by His command, by His leave and with His knowledge. iVerily, We are ever sending,} means, to mankind, sending Messenger who will recite to them the clear signs of Allah. The need for this was urgent. <(As) a mercy from your Lord. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower. The Lord of the heavens and the earth and all that is

between them,} means, the One Who sent down the Qur'an is the Lord, Creator and Sovereign of the heavens and the earth and everything in between them. ^ 4} 4ifyou (but) have a faith with certainty.} Then Allah says: v \$2j .Jf. _y» V) i)) y} m At-Tabari 22 :9

iThen wait you for the Day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke.} It was narrated that Masruq said, "We entered the Masjid - i.e., the Masjid of Kufah at the gates of Kindah - and a man was reciting to his companions, 4the Day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke.} He asked them; *Do you know what that is?' That is the smoke that will come on the Day of Resurrection. It will take away the hearing and sight of the hypocrites, but for the believers it will be like having a cold.'" He said, "We came to Ibn MasMd, may Allah be pleased with him, and told him about that. He was lying down, and he sat up with a start and said, 'Allah said to your Prophet Si "0 Zj jS& & 4Say : "No wage do I ask ofyou for this, nor am I one of the pretenders."' (38:86). And it is part of knowledge that when a man does not know something, he should say, 'Allah knows best.' 1 will tell you a Hadith about that. When the Quraysh did not respond to Islam and they grew stubborn, the Messenger of Allah Sg invoked Allah against them that they would have years like the years (of drought and famine) of Yusuf. They became so exhausted and hungry that they ate bones and dead meat. They looked at the sky, but they saw nothing but smoke.'" According to another report: "A man would look at the sky and he would see nothing between him and the sky except a smoky haze, because of his exhaustion."*2 ili Jll!J! pi 4Then wait you for the Day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke, covering the people, this is a painfiil torment} A man came to the Messenger of Allah jg and said, "O Messenger of Allah! Pray to Allah to send rain to Mudar, for I1 * Muslim 4:2155. ' Muslim 4:2156.

j 'fJ* J>} ^4* £>rk IjUj iwJyiJl a j I<Jjl> il^IU d-I>- (4^* *~t5 ~ 44* 4* Ji •IjJU ^ J4?J *The Hour will not come until you see ten signs. The rising of the sun from the west; the smoke; the beast; the emergence of Ya'juj and Ma'juj; the appearance of 'Jsd bin Maryam; the Dajjal; three cases of the earth collapsing - one in the east, one in the west, and one in the Arabian Peninsula; and a fire which will emerge from the bottom ofAden and will drive the people - or gather the people - stopping with them when they stop to sleep at night or rest during the day.*" This was recorded only by Muslim in his Sahth [1) In the Two Sahlhs it was recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Ibn Sayyad: •Li- htuoL>- ^1 »I am concealing something for you.* He said, It is Ad-Dukh. The Prophet 3^5 said, *bjji jJbu L>Il "Be off with you! You cannot get further than your rank.* He said, "The Messenger ofAllah sis was concealing from him the words; iThen wait you for the Day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke.y* * This indicates that the smoke is yet to appear. Ibn Sayyad was a fortune-teller who heard things through the Jinn, whose speech is unclear, therefore he said, "It is Ad- Dukh," meaning Ad-Dukhan (the smoke). When the Messenger of Allah sgs was sure what was happening, that the source of 111 Muslim 4:2225. The last phrase, beginning with "He said..." and mentioning the Ayah is not part of the Hadtth in the Two Sahlhs as noted earlier. See FathAl-B&ri3 :258 ; Muslim 4:2240 for the narrations.

his information was the Shayatin, he jg said: jJL«J 1—>- 1 "Be offwith you! You cannot getfurther than your rank .» There are numerous Marfa' and Mawquf Hadiths, Sahih, Hasan and others, which indicate that the smoke is one of the awaited signs (of the Hour). This is also the apparent meaning ofAyat in the Qur'an. Allah says: iThen wait you for the Day when the sky will bring forth a visible smoke. meaning,

clearly visible, such that all people will see it. According to Ibn Mas'ud's interpretation, this was a vision which they saw because of their intense hunger and exhaustion. He also interprets the Ayah iCovering mankind,} meaning, it covered them and overwhelmed them. But if it was only an illusion which happened to the idolators of Makkah, Allah would not have said "covering mankind." 4>Ijc ithis is a painful torment.} means, this will be said to them by way of rebuke. This is like the Ayah: iThe Day when they will be pushed down byforce to thefire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. This is the Fire which you used to deny.} (52:13-14). Or some of them will say that to others. aj} i(They will say) : "Our Lord! Remove the torment from us, really we shall become believers!"} means, when the disbelievers witness the punishment of Allah they will ask for it to be taken away from them. This is Hire the Ayat.

& jPs eV <9V^ 4^3 Sf> ij> udij ijlla jp s[2y 4If you could, but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say "Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Aydt ofour Lord, and we would be of the believers!") (6:27) 4 yj £\ t2; lAii 2\$ #3 iLo y; ^ 4And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them; then the wrongdoers will say: "Our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your Call and follow the Messengers!" (It will be said): "Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave (the worldfor the Hereafter).) (14:44) Allah says here: # tjejs% iHow can there be for them an admonition, when a Messenger explaining things clearly has already come to them. Then they had turned away from him and said: "(He is) one taught, a madman!") meaning, *what further admonition do they need when We have sent them a Messenger with a clear Message and warning? Yet despite that, they turned away from him, opposed him and rejected him, and they said: (He is) one taught (by a human being), a madman.' This is like the Ayah: iOn that Day will man remember, but how will that remembrance (then) avail him?) (89:23) P 6b ^{^5 £> 1^4 (jt iAnd ifyou could but see, when they will be terrified with no escape, and they will be seizedfrom a near place. And they will say (in the Hereafter): "We do believe (now);" but.how could they receive (faith and its acceptance by AllSh) from a place so far off...) (34:51-52)

UJi yIUi iy^IT GI^ iVerily, We shall remove the torment for a while. Verily, yon will revert . means, 'if We were to remove the torment from you for a while, and send you back to the world, you would go back to your former state of disbelief and denial.' This is like the Ayat. iAnd though We had mercy on them and removed the distress which is on them, still they would obstinately persist in their transgression, wandering blindly.) (23:75) & Si£ Q !/>u&%) iBut if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars) (6:28) The Meaning ofthe "Great Batshah" is# & iOn the Day when We shall strike you with the great Batshah. Verily, We will exact retribution.) Ibn Mas'Qd interpreted this to mean the day of Badr. (1) This is also the view of a group who agreed with Ibn Mas'Qd, may Allah be pleased with him, about the meaning of the smoke, as discussed above. It was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, in a report related to him from Al- 'Awfi12 ' and from Ubayy bin Ka*b, may Allah be pleased with him. 131 This is possible, but the apparent meaning is that it refers to the Day of Resurrection, although the day of Badr was also a day of vengeance. Ibn Jarir said, "Ya'qub narrated to me; Ibn TJlayyah narrated to me, Khalid Al-Hadhdha' narrated to us, from Ikrimah who said, Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Ibn At-Tabari 22:22. At-Tabari 22:22. 131 At-Tabari 22:23.

^y, ^ ^ ji,> »x { A/' j>/ ^ ^ toi 0>^yu'yvJjvA/ t£jLjoy^jIs oy*j£ »<Vj >j v^pojs^i* A^r ^1/J <->*— 'S' \<" , H' -' :{<; >***> lAe ^ Usiji-^U_jsl^jLyjljviU ^ jvgS^lf-s'jii ,jijX-jz^p-'^y/aSJjiiij ^{j\$JZZ&j*Q\co% c^sif £j<3. SjjB3p>o[^ jij(1£p Oji-cS («\$S^juJoS fg) 0 \$£&£ Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said that “the great Batshah” is the day of Badr, and I say that it is the Day of Resurrection.” This chain of narration is Sahth to him. This is also the view of Al- Hasan Al-Basri and of Ikrimah according to the more authentic of the two reports narrated from him. And Allah knows best. £>yji 'ft ~*£j 63 \$ o' ifoj 'P> 4i >Cfi 3[Oj je yii V j'j u>^ Oji ,r^yVJ y'lilij .{ ,, yji. . •>«••; < {<-. ... > oy .^,vyvt/ o' >vjj 44 Ji Lai J prl •!»£> t!/'j ^'Os*^ p^«il i£jL« ft *\$P .\ . .., r>j> V ,^.. >>. ,,-m. >> ' -' •Vf. .-j^ ^ V- !>*® *~~•> guis -t&ifr h <j&r at \yy ** " ^Ojb^ Ig> tif JiJj QpiiJ&A Jy{ Cj jtf^c C^J Li '^pO^i-L Ly Lljijlj viU'j^" d® |»VjA>-' 'j'lp'O^r—J' OJ Lljc ,*jt_ ihyCj Oi Ji&-1 ^W 6 oj (4^*^ J* ^i <17. And indeed We tried before them Fir'coon's people, when there came to them a noble Messenger.} 418. Saying: “Deliver to me the servants of Allah. Verily, I am to you a Messenger worthy of all trust.”} 419. "And exalt not yourselves against Allah. Truly, I have

come to you with a manifest authority 420. "And truly, I seek refuge with my Lord and your Lord, lest you should stone me."} 421 . “But if you believe me not, then keep away from me and leave me alone.”} 422. So he (Musa) called upon his Lord (saying) : "These are indeed the people who are criminals."} 423. (Allah said): "Depart you with My servants by night. Surely, you will be pursued."} 424. "And leave the sea as it is (quiet and divided). Verily, they are a host to be drowned."} 425. How many of gardens and springs that they (Fir'awn's people) left behind, 426. And green crops (fields) and goodly places,} 427. And comforts of life wherein they used to take delight!} 428 . Thus (it was)! And We made other people inherit them .} 429. And the heavens and the earth wept not for them, nor were they given respite.} 430. And indeed We saved the Children of Israel from the humiliating torment,} 431. From Fir'awn; verily, he was arrogant and was of the excessive .} 432. And We chose them above the nations (Al-'Alamin) with knowledge,} 433. And granted them signs in which there was a plain trial.} The Story of Musa and Fir'awn, and how the Children of Israel were saved Allah tells us, ‘before these idolators, We tested the people of Fir'awn, the copts of Egypt.’ 4when there came to them a noble Messenger.} means, Mfisa, peace be upon him, the one to whom Allah spoke. 4& stx a)}

681 Surah 44. Ad-Dukhan (17 - 33) (Part-25) iDeliver to me the servants of Allah.} This is like the Ayah, if & at Sis; j* fci** "i> Ji£~} ^So /el the Children of Israel go with us, and torment them not; indeed, we have come with a sign from your Lord! And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance!"} (20:47) &P 4i> iVerily, I am to you a Messenger worthy of all trust.} means, Svhat I convey to you is trustworthy.' i%£ \fn y&} \$And exalt not yourselves against Allah.} means, ‘and do not be too arrogant to follow His signs. Accept His proof and believe in His evidence.’ This is like the Ayah iVerily, those who scorn My worship they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!} (40:60) 4jv* ip~i iTndy, I have come to you with a manifest authority.} means, with clear and obvious proof. This refers to the clear signs and definitive evidence with which Allah sent him. oj* \$>} }And truly, I seek refuge with my Lord and your Lord, lest you should stone me.} Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and Abu Salih said, “This refers to a verbal assault, which means insults.” Qatadah said, “Meaning ‘stoning’ in the literal sense, so that the meaning is: *1 seek refuge with Allah, Who created me and you, from your making any harmful words or actions reach me.” 121 111 AMabari 22:26. 121 Al-Tabari 22 :27.

And indeed We revealed to Moses (saying) : "Travel by night with My servants and strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken nor being afraid (of drowning in the sea)." (20:77) > '.*. » And leave the sea as it is (quiet and divided). Verily, they are a host to be drowned.} When Moses and the Children of Israel has crossed the sea, Pharaoh wanted to strike it with his staff so that it would go back as it had been, and it would form a barrier between them and Fir'awn and prevent him from reaching them. But Allah commanded him to leave it as it was, quiet and divided, and gave him the glad tidings that they were a host to be drowned, and that he should not fear either being overtaken by Fir'awn or drowning in the sea. Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: And leave the sea as it is (quiet and divided). means, leave it as it is and keep moving. 111 Mujahid said: 4<JS it is} means, a dry path, as it is. 'Do not command it to go back; leave it until the last of them have entered it. This was also the view of 'Ikrimah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Zayd, Ka'b Al-Ahbar, Simak bin Harb and others.131 How many of gardens and springs hurt they left behind. And green crops this refers to rivers and wells. and goodly places,} means, fine dwellings and beautiful places. Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said: 111 Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 7 :410 121 At-Tabari 22:30. 131 At-Tabari 22:30.

684 Tafsir Ibn Kathir <t>jm 4 and goodly places, means elevated places. 4 And comforts of life wherein they used to take delight!} means, a life which they were enjoying, where they could eat whatever they wanted and wear what they liked, with wealth and glory and power in the land. Then all of that was taken away in a single morning, they departed from this world and went to Hell, what a terrible abode! 4 Thus (it was)! And We made other people inherit them.} namely the Children of Israel. 4 And the heavens and the earth wept not for them,} means, they had no righteous deeds which used to ascend through the gates of the heavens, which would weep for them when they died, and they had no places on earth where they used to worship Allah which would notice their loss. So they did not deserve to be given a respite, because of their disbelief, sin, transgression and stubbornness. Ibn Jarir recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, "A man came to Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and said to him: 'O Abu Al-'Abbas, Allah says, 4 And the heavens and the earth wept not for them, nor were they given respite} - do the heavens and the earth weep for anybody?' He, may Allah be pleased with him, said, 'Yes, there is no one who does not have a gate in the heavens through which his provision comes down and his good deeds ascend. When the believer dies, that gate is closed; it misses him and weeps for him, and the place of prayer on earth where he used to pray and m At-Tabari 22 :32

remember Allah also weeps for him. But the people of Fir'awn left no trace of righteousness on the earth and they had no good deeds that ascended to Allah, so the heavens and the earth did not weep for them.'"111 Al-'Awfi reported something similar from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him.*21 Jt Ojc 5^ Ji 1-iUjf Cji JiCr-1 Zgi X&j} 4 And indeed We saved the Children of Israel from the humiliating torment from Fir'awn ; verily, he was arrogant and was of the excessive.} Here Allah reminds them of how He saved them from their humiliation and subjugation at the hands of Fir'awn, when they were forced to do menial tasks. <Ji} iFrom Fir'awn; verily, he was arrogant} means, he was proud and stubborn. This is like the Ayah: 4 Verily, Fir'awn exalted himself in the land} (28:4). iBut they behaved insolently and they were people self-exalting} (23:46). He was one of the excessive and held a foolish opinion of himself. je jX-J;& J%j} 4 And We chose them above the nations (Al-'Alamin) with knowledge,} Mujahid said, "This means that they were chosen above those among whom they lived." Qatadah said, "They were chosen above the other people of their own time, and it was said that in every

period there are people who are chosen above others.” This is like the Ayah: 111 At-Tabari 22:34. AMabari 22:35.

4oi&’ jp 4l lry± i(Allah) said: "O Musa / have chosen you above men.") (7:144), which means, above the people of his time. This is also like the Ayah. (Allah has) chosen you (Maryam) above the women of the nations (Al-'Alamtn.) (3:42), i.e., Maryam was chosen above the women of her time. For Khadljah, may Allah be pleased with her, is higher than her in status or is equal to her, as was Asiyah bint Muzahim, the wife of Fir'awn. And the superiority of 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, over all other women is like the superiority of Tharvd over all other dishes. Si^~j) 4And granted them signs^ means clear proofs and extraordinary evidence. 4 ~ e» 4in which there was a plain trial. means, an obvious test to show who would be guided by it. 434. Verily, these people are saying :) 435. "There is nothing but our first death, and we shall not be resurrected.") 436. "Then bring back our forefathers, if you speak the truth!") 437. Are they better or the people of Tubba' and those before them? We destroyed them because they were indeed criminals.) Refutation of Those Who deny the Resurrection Here Allah denounces the idolaters for their denial of the Resurrection and their belief that there is nothing after this

life and no life or resurrection after death, which they based on the fact that their forefathers had died and had not returned. They said. If the resurrection is true, {Then bring back our forefathers, if you speak the truth 1.} This is false evidence and a specious argument, for the resurrection will happen on the Day of Judgement, not in this world; it will happen when this world has ended and ceased to be. Allah will bring all creatures back, created anew. He will make the evildoers fuel for the fire of Hell, and on that Day you will be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger will be a witness over you. Then Allah threatens them and warns them of the irresistible torment other idolaters like who denied the resurrection, suffered. Such as the people of Tubba', i.e., Saba'. Allah destroyed them, wreaked havoc upon their land and scattered them here and there throughout the land, as we have already seen in Surah Saba'f This was brought about because the idolaters denied the Resurrection. Here too, the idolaters are compared to them. They Tubba' were Arab descendants of Qahtan, just as these people (Quraysh) were Arab descendants of 'Adn&n. Among the people of Himyar - who are also known as Saba' - when a man became their king, they called him Tubba', just as the title Chosroes was given to the king of Persia, Caesar to the king of the Romans, Fir'awn to the disbelieving ruler of Egypt, Negus to the king of Ethiopia, and so on among other nations. But it so happened that one of the Tubba' left Yemen and went on a journey of conquest until he reached Samarqand, expanding his kingdom and domain. He is the one who founded Al-Hirah. It is agreed that he passed through Al- Madfnah during the days of Jahiliyyah. He fought its inhabitants but they resisted him; they fought him by day and supplied him with food by night, so he felt ashamed before them and refrained from harming them. He was accompanied by two Jewish rabbis who advised him and told him that he would never prevail over this city, for it would be the place to which a Prophet would migrate towards the end of time. So he (il See volume seven the Tafstrof Surah Saba' (34 :15-19)

y retreated and took yyJo%y% t*1™ (th« two rabbis) y^ ' ' ^ >x> > >•./ , with him to Yemen. When he passed by ^J?j>£l£Sd>l^ Makkah, he wanted to 1 destroy the Ka'bah, ^-SV'f^ but they told him not -If \ X >A •** >> ' If P _>«ok_>J i •». . (3 ^ » >tJ) ^ (3^5 jfiye—s=6\j^j^c^ ^ JC^j to do that either. They

told him about the significance of this House, that it had been built by Ibrahim Al-Khalil, peace be upon him, and that it would become of great importance through that Prophet who would be sent towards the end of time - So he respected it, ZiklZZU performed Tawaf with it with a fine cloth. Then he returned to Yemen and invited its people to follow the religion of guidance along with him. At that time, the religion of Musa, peace be upon him, was the religion followed by those who were guided, before the coming of the Messiah, peace be upon him. So the people of Yemen accepted the religion of guidance along with him. 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "The Messenger of Allah said: 'do not know whether Tubba' was a Prophet or not' Al-Baghawi 4:154. It has deficiencies, in the mode of narration and the wording of the text. However, there are a number of authentic narrations that support its general meaning. See As-Sahihah

It was narrated that Tamim bin 'Abdur-Rahman said: " 'Ata' bin Abi Rabah said, 'Do not revile Tubba', for the Messenger of Allah forbade reviling him.'" And Allah knows best. And We created not the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, for mere play. We created them not except with truth, but most of them know not.} 440. Verily, the Day of Judgement is the time appointed for all of them -} 441. The Day when a near relative cannot avail a near relative in aught, and no help can they receive,} 442. Except him on whom Allah has mercy. Verily, He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} This World was created for a Wisdom Here Allah tells us of His justice, and that He is far above mere play, folly and falsehood. This is like the Ayah: 4 And We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire!} (38:27) 4 Did you think that We had created you in play, and that you would not be brought back to Us? So Exalted be Allah, the True King: La ilaha ila Huwa, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} (23:115-116) 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :209

4 Verily, He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful. > means, he is the Almighty, with immense mercy. Verily, the tree of Zaqqum} 444. Will be the food of the sinners.} 445. Like boiling oil, it will boil in the bellies,} 446. Like the boiling of scalding water.} 447. (It will be said :) "Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire," 448. "Then pour over his head the torment of boiling water."} 449. "Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous."} 450. "Verily, this is that whereof you used to doubt!"} The Condition of the Idolaters and Their Punishment on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us how He will punish the disbelievers who deny the meeting with Him: 4 Verily, the tree of Zaqqum will be the food of the sinners.} Those who sinned by their words and in deeds. These are the disbelievers. More than one commentator stated that this referred to Abu Jahl; undoubtedly he is included among those referred to in this Ayah, but it is not specifically about him. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Ad-Darda' was reciting to a man: 4 Verily, the tree of Zaqqum will be the food of the sinners.} The man said, "The food of the orphan." Abu Ad-Darda', may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Say, the tree of Zaqqum is the food of the evildoer." * i.e., he will not have any other food 111 At-Tabari 22 :43

apart from that. Mujahid said, "If a drop of it were to fall on the earth, it would corrupt the living of all the people of earth." 111 A similar Marfa' report has been narrated earlier. i Like boiling oil,} means, like

the dregs of oil. iit will boil in the bellies, like the boiling ofscalding water.} means, because of its heat and rancidity. ioU iSeize him} means the disbeliever. It was reported that when Allah says to the keepers of Hell, “Seize him,” seventy thousand ofthem will rush to seize him. \$and drag him} means, drag him by pulling him and pushing him on his back. Mujahid said: iSeize him and drag him} means, take him and push him. iinto the midst ofblazing Fire, ^means, into the middle of it. kjAi* Ji *4—1) t3j> f} iThen pour over his head the torment of boiling water.} This is like the Ayah: iboiling water will be poured down over their heads. With it will melt what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins.} (22:19-20). The angel will strike him with a hooked rod of iron and split his head open, then he will pour boiling water over his head. It will go down through his body, melting through his stomach m At-Tabari 22 :43

and intestines, until it goes through his heels; may Allah protect us from that. iTaste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous.} means, they (the keepers of Hell) will say that to him by way of ridicule and rebuke. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “This means, you are neither mighty nor generous.” And Allah’s saying: 4i^of/ui li dti iVerily, this is that whereofyou used to doubt!} is like His saying: \$ 'j0 0 iThe Day when they will be pushed down byforce to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forcefol pushing. This is the Fire which you used to deny. In this magic, or do you not see?} (52: 13- 15) Similarly Allah said: iVerily, this is that where ofyou used to doubt!} jl -- j.:< Ti&OjriiS 451. Verily, those who have Taqwa, will be in place of security.} 452. Among Gardens and Springs,} 453. Dressed in Sundus and Istabraq, facing each other,}

454. So (it will be). And We shall marry them to Hur (fair females) with wide lovely eyes , 455. They will call therein for every kind offruit in peace and security;) 456. They will never taste death therein except the first death, and He will save themfrom the torment of the blazing Fire,) 457. As a bounty from your Lord! That will be the supreme success!) 458. Certainly, We have made this easy in your tongue, in order that they may remember.) 459. Wait then; verily, they (too) are waiting.) The State ofThose Who have Taqwa and the Delights They will enjoy in Paradise When Allah describes the state of the doomed, He follows that with a description of the life of the blessed. For this reason the Qur’an is called Al-Mathani (i.e., oft-repeated). 4Verily, those who have Taqwa,) i.e., those who fear Allah and are dutiful towards Him in this world, 4will be in place of security.) means, in the Hereafter, i.e., in Paradise, where they will be safe from death and the fear of leaving it, and from every kind of worry, grief, terror and exhaustion, and from the Shay(an and his wiles, and from all other troubles and disasters. 4Among Gardens and Springs). This is in direct contrast to the state of the doomed, who will have the tree of Zaqqum and boiling water. 4<Jp-X-Z> Ji CljL£) 4Dressed in Sundus) means, the finest of silk, such as shirts and the like. Ayfj&Ci)

695Surah 44. Ad-Dukhan (51 - 59) (Part-75) iand Istabraq} means, silk which is woven with shiny threads, like a splendid garment which is worn over regular clothes. ifacing each other,} means, sitting on thrones where none ofthem will sit with his back to anyone else. jfo. <tyj£=>} iSo (it will be). And We shall marry them to Hur (fairfemales) with wide lovely eyes,} This will be a gift in addition to the beautifulwives given tothem. Kjpat% j} iwith whom no man or Jinn has had Tamth (sexual intercourse) before them.} (55:56) i(In beauty) they are like rubies and Marjdn.} (55:58) ji} ils there any rewardfor good other than good?} (55:60) iThey will call therein for every kind of fruit in peace and security;}

means, whatever kinds of fruit they ask for will be brought to them, and they will have the security of knowing that this supply will never come to an end or be withheld; these fruits will be brought to them whenever they want. i%Si\ ^ op'f)} iThey will never taste death therein except thefirst death,} This is an exception which reinforces the negation. The meaning is that they will never taste death there. It was reported in the Two Sahtiis that the Messenger of Allah ^ said: It is often translated as “coral”. See Ibn Kathlr’s comments in volume nine , (55 :58)

696 Tafsir Ibt KathTr : JliJ p iii >-"j? £^t SJ>b i/! b'V j^1>- jdll jit Ijj ioji tAi j^1>- <l>Jl Ja! C tDeath will be broughtforth in the image ofa fine ram. It will be made to stand between Paradise and Hell, then it will be slaughtered. It will be said, "O people ofParadise, it is eternal, no more death; and O people of Hell, it is eternal, no more death."»m This Hadith was already quoted in our discussion of Surah Maryam. ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Said and Abu Hurayrah said, “The Messenger of Allah jg said: \fL^ it Uj » li't 1 1 it jl : £±2>\ JiSl JliI I j? <jp l ijbt l^itl: *AJ I (jt n>£J j\j i Ult Iyy*0 <ilt will be said to the people of Paradise, "It is granted to you that you will be healthy and will neverfall ill, you will live and never die, you will enjoy a life of luxury and will never be miserable, you will be youthful and will never grow old."»” This was recorded by Muslim.12’ It was reported that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “The Messenger of Allah^ said: v wiJb V "Ai Ifi UAjj i,i-tli Nj Ifj <.< @4jlli fJ lAJUl *Whoever has Taqwa ofAllah, he will enter Paradise and enjoy / a life of luxury and he will never be miserable. He will live therein and never die, his clothes will never wear out and his youth will neverfade.»”*31 iand He will save themfrom the torment of the blazing Fire,} means, along with this great and eternal blessing, He will also 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :282 ; Muslim 4 :2188 ’2| Muslim 4:2182. ’3 Aj-Tabarani in Al-Awsat4895

have saved them from the agonizing torment in the depths ofHeU so they will have achieved their desired aim and avoidedthe thing they feared. Allah says, j* Suj iAs a bounty from your Lord! That will be the supremesuccess!) r meaning, that will be from His bounty and kindness towards Allahi Sd-rePOrte<1 ^ TW° that the Messenger of &J. iki; &JM j&j I and strive hard, and know that no one will enter Paradise by virtue ofhis deedsJ They said, “Not even you, O Messenger of Allah?” He sg said, <i>> M vj >. u(’‘Not even me, unless Allah showers me with His mercy and grace .<m 3 r&l 4Certainly, We have made this easy in your tongue, in order that they may remember.) means, We have made this Qur’an, which We have sent down, easy, plain and clear, in your language which is the most eloquent, clear and beautiful of all languages.’ iin order that they may remember.) means, in order that theymay understand and know. Despite the fact that it is so plain and clear, there are still people who disbelieve, who stubbornly go against it. Allah says to His Messenger s&, consoling him and promising him victory, and warning those who reject him that they will be destroyed. iWait then; verily, they (too) are waiting.) meaning, ‘they will m Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :300 ; Muslim 4 :2 170

come to know who will be victorious and whose word wdl prevail in this world and in the Hereafter. For victory wrfl be for you, O Muhammad, and for your brothers among the Prophets and Messengers, and for the believers who foUowed you, as Allah says: ft lit iAUSh has decreed: ‘‘Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious (58 :21) x i z &&0 aw m ^ ip&tA jtfj 4Verity, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the

witnesses will stand forth , - the Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers. Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (40 :51-52)

Surah 45: Al-Jathiyah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5301–5303]

Opening Jr The Tafslr of SuratAl-Jathiyah (Chapter - 45) Whichwas revealed in Makkah -sgfl^0P *-tgatis sr\i csjP140JCO (0 (*-> IZC&ji&CyfpLj;0 4I1 ' jfPjijj ' Pj o JjA<i2j\+ -***uf*S\$1 ot Jjo JL*-4js\j am\col» j^iibu p.0JA\p^j0Z2&&&& •S fj •* i >.\ ' • -.1 < <?>>> , ' In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. \$ « PPf 4s? ^Slf— 4 PSPP jfP jj yP JfjiS ;& 5# & jj ii g -j4ii tj 4^ ' -i' y~I> ii.'Hj-w L*-U (jjJ J4 Oi ill' 4/*' {fif >-*U*»J \f,S -*») o>N' *1 /yd 41 . Ha Mfm.^ 42 . The revelation of the Book is from Allah, the Almighty, the All- Wise.\$ 43. Verily, in the heavens and the earth are signs for the believers.\$ 44. And in your creation, and what He spread (through the earth) of moving creatures are signs for people who have faith with certainty. 45 . And in the alternation of night and day, and the provision that Allah sends down from the sky, and revives therewith the 0 ^

earth after its death, and in the turning about of the winds, are signsfor a people who understand> A Directive to contemplate over Allah's kyat Allah directs His servants to contemplate His favors and gifts, as well as His great power that is demonstrated by His creating the heavens and the earth and the various types and categories of creatures in them. There are the angels, Jinns, humans, animals, birds, beasts, carnivores, insects and various kinds of sea creatures. The night and day alternate, each follows the other in succession, never ceasing to come, as decreed. One brings darkness and one brings light. Allah the Exalted also sends down the rain from the clouds when it is most needed. He is calling the rain, “provision’, because it is the resource that produces various provisions, i* J.;V(iand revives therewith the earth after its death,} after it was diy and had no vegetation or life of any kind. Allah said next, iand in the turning about of the winds,} sometimes towards the south and sometimes towards the north. Some are easterly winds and some are westerly winds, some bringing sea breezes and some blow from the land, some coming at night and some by day. Some winds bring rain, some cause pollination and some’ winds just revive the soul, while some others bear no benefit. Allah said first. iare signs for the believers}, then iwho havefaith with certainty}, then

19Surah 45. Al-ldthiuah (6-11) (Part-25) 4who understand}, thus ascending from one honorable stage to

what is more honorable and higher in grade. These Ayat are

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similar to an Ayah in SuratAl-Baqarah lij JCM 4 oi?jv!S v>*—^ 4?^ 4 *1^ t£*J J-«j JeH" Jj OJ 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, and the ships which

sail through the sea with that which is of use to mankind, and the water which Allah sends down from the sky and makes the earth alive therewith after its death, and the moving creatures of all kinds that He has spread therein, and in the veering of winds and clouds which are held between the sky and the earth, are indeed signs for people of understanding.} (2:164) j v) ^ cS^ (3*^ coj j4* 'j)j Vs* ^^ bp-* !rn'f&& LA 4"- *£> f-i*- 01 jvi & fei j£2f jj'j SJJ* 'xi 4*'J» Jvlj •Pj' <i' Ojj y U "jj [ji >*y oi pi pr-> 46. These are the Ayat of Allah, which We recite to you with truth. Then in which speech after Allah and His Ayat will they believe?} 47. Woe to every sinful liar.} 48. Who hears the Ayat of Allah Tutld (recited) to him, yet persists with pride as if he heard them not. So announce to him a painful torment!} 49. And when he learns something of Our Ayat, he makes them a jest. For such there will be a humiliating torment.} 410. In front of them there is Hell. And that which they have earned will be of no profit to them, nor those whom they have taken as protective friends besides Allah. And theirs will be a great torment.} 411 This is guidance. And those who disbelieve in the Ayat of their Lord, for them there is a painful torment of Rijz.}

The Description of the Sinful Liar and His Requital Allah the Exalted says, iTThese are the Ayat of Allah} - in reference to the Qur'an with the proofs and evidences that it contains, iwhich We recite to you with truth .} for they contain the truth from the Truth (i.e., Allah). Therefore, if they do not believe in Allah's Ayat nor abide by them, what speech after Allah and His Ayat will they then believe in? Allah said next, iWj\$P>> 4Woe to even\ sinful liar.} who lies in his speech, often swears, who is worthless, commits and utters sinful acts and state- ments, and disbelieves in Allah's Ayat, V'-i'* ^ iWho hears the Ayat of Allah Tutla (recited) to him,} meaning, being recited to him, iyet persists} in his disbelief, denial, pride and rebellion, ias if he heard them not.} as if he did not hear them being recited to him, iSo announce to him a painful torment!} convey the news to him that on the Day of Resurrection, he will have a painful, severe torment from Allah. Allah said, iAnd when he learns something of Our Ayat, he makes them a jest.} if he learns anything from the Qur'an, he disbelieves in it and takes it as the subject of jest and ridicule,

21 Surah 45. Al-Jdthiuh (6-11) (Part-25) v'j* jlii iFor such there will be a humiliating torment.) as recompense for ridiculing the Qur'an and jesting about it. In the Sahih, Muslim recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Umar that the Messenger of Allah Si prohibited traveling with the Qur'an to enemy lands for fear that the Qur'an might be desecrated by the enemy. 11 ' Allah explained the type of torment that these people earn on the Day of Return; iln front of them there is Hell.) meaning, all those who have these evil characteristics will end up in Hellfire on the Day of Resurrection, 1^ u pr* Of iAnd that which they have earned will be of no profit to them,) their wealth and children will not avail them, jif oj> o; 1m*' U yj) inor those whom they have taken as protecting friends besides Allah.) nor will the false gods that they worshipped besides Allah benefit them in the least, d>\Jx. \$j) iAnd theirs will be a great torment.) Allah the Exalted said, iTThis is Huda (guidance).) in reference to the Qur'an, iAnd those who disbelieve in the Ayat of their Lord, for them there is a painful torment of Rijz.) that is agonizing and severe. Allah knows best. Muslim 3:1491.

412. Allah, it is He Who has subjected to you the sea, that ships may sail through it by His command, and that you may seek of His bounty, and that you may be thankful.} 413. And has subjected to you all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth; it is all (as a favor and kindness) from Him. Verily, in it

are signs for a people who think deeply.} 414. Say to the believers to forgive those who hope not for the Days of Allah, that He may recompense people, according to what they have earned. 415. Whosoever does a good deed, it is for himself, and whosoever does evil, it is against (himself). Then to your Lord you will be made to return. The Subjugation of the Sea, etc., is among Allah's Signs Allah the Exalted mentions some of the favors He gave to His servants, such as subjecting the sea for their service, 4-1^i ii 4that ships may sail through the sea by His command,} i.e., of Allah the Exalted, Who ordered the sea to carry ships, 4and that you may seek of His bounty,} in commercial and business transactions, 4and that you may be thankful.} for earning various provisions brought to you from far away provinces and distant areas through the sea. Allah the Exalted said, 4And has subjected to you all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth ;}

23 Surah 45. Al-Jdthiyah (12-15) (Part-25) the stars, the mountains, the seas, the rivers and all that you use for your benefit; these are all from His favor, kindness and bounty. Allah's statement next,)it is all from Him.) Alone without partners in giving any of it. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, (iJjZJp b) ui iAnd whatever of blessings you have, it is from Allah. Then, when harm touches you unto Him you cry aloud for help.) (16:53) Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4*4 4 '-J 4 ^ [^—j) iAnd has subjected to you all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth ; it is all from Him.) "Everything is from Allah, and that is a Name from His Names. So it all comes from Him without rivals to dispute His authority; surely, this fact is completely certain." Allah said. iVerily, in it are signs for a people who think deeply.) The Command to be Patient with the Harm of Idolaters Allah's saying; OjJy. V irM. iSay to the believers to forgive those who hope not for the Days of Allah,) means, let the believers forgive the disbelievers and endure the harm that they direct against them. In the beginning of Islam, Muslims were ordered to observe patience in the face of the oppression of the idolaters and the People of the Scriptures so that their hearts may incline towards Islam. However, when the disbelievers persisted in m At-Tabari 22 :65

stubbornness, Allah legislated for the believers to fight in Jihad. Statements of this meaning were collected from 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas and Qatfidah. Mujahid said about Allah's statement, cijj) v} i those who hope not for the Days of Allah,} "They do not appreciate Allah's favors."*21 Allah said, i that He may recompense people, according to what they have earned.} meaning, if the believers forgive the disbelievers in this life, Allah will still punish the disbelievers for their evil in the Hereafter. Allah's statement next, iWl wsoever does a good deed, it is for himself, and whosoever does evil, it is against (himself). Then to your Lord you will be made to return.} meaning, you will all return to Allah on the Day of Resurrection, when you and your actions will be displayed before Him. Then, He will recompense you for your deeds, good for good and evil for evil. i&i\$ ac%} k^ H* (Uit cM Oin tJESa Si \$ ot £j 'JJjf pj xAl'j OJyUiJI y^ > 426. And indeed We gave the Qildren of Israel the Scripture, and tire understanding of the Scripture and its laws, and the prophethood; and provided them with good things, and At-Tabari 22:66, 67. At-Tabari 22:67.

25 Surah 45. Al-Mhiuah (16-20) (Part-25) preferred them above the nations. il7. And gave them clear proofs in matters. And they differed not until after the knowledge came to them, through envy among themselves. Verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection about that wherein they used to differ.) 418. Then We have put you on a (legal) way of commandment So follow you that,

and follow not the desires of those who know not.) 419. Verily, they can avail you nothing against Allah. Verily, the wrongdoers are protecting friends of one another, but Allah is the Protector of those who have Taqwa.) 420. This is a clear insight and evidence for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy for people who have faith with certainty.) Preference of Allah to the Children of Israel and their dispute thereafter Allah the Exalted mentions the favors He granted the Children of Israel, such as revealing the Divine Books to them, sending the Messengers to them and granting them kingship. Allah said, 4ci& \$ 225 ac £j) 4And indeed We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, and the understanding of the Scripture and its laws, and the prophethood ; and provided them with good things,) such as foods and drinks, 4and preferred them above the nations.) of their time, 4And gave them clear proofs in matters.) *We gave them evidences, proofs and unequivocal signs.' Therefore, the proof has been established against them, yet they differed among themselves after the proof came to them, out of transgression against each other,

27Surah 45. Al-Idhwah (21-23) (Part-25) rJ eSHHfcSosaii® « X * J ^» X ^ 'J >< < | •/> *) s * } IjI0} *r£J.cLjuU, !>~* '« 'SaamiS 'V 477iis is a c/ertr insight oii4?iisiyi|Ci:Wj^«viiJE3G <c«^yi£.Ajb) tj5iLJl_/J-ajJC*^^ <£>~L> <><>!*f*>' * S's' ' and evidence far man- kind,} in reference to the Qur'an, 4& .s'." iand a guidance and a mercy for people who have \faith with certainty.} CtM Vrr*- !£sc tfir4& J ot£Ji 4^ ^ ^4iit SK ce£c; ^ JiVfj **3? iif c, cpS Jr a&fc V jUj ££ &Z& mJi •is**, j6 J»»-j *<Jij •jm- ^ <i'4 Si *> *J4 421 . Or do those who earn evil deeds think that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds, in their present life and after their death? Worst is the judgement that they make.} 422. And Allah has created the heavens and the earth with truth, in order that each person may be recompensed what he has earned, and they will not be wronged.} 423. Have you seen him who takes his own lust as his god? And Allah, left him astray with knowledge, and sealed his hearing and his heart, and put a cover on his sight. Who then will guide him after Allah? Will you not then remember?}

The Life and the Death of the Believers and the Disbelievers are not Equal Allah the Exalted states here that the believers and the disbelievers are never equal. Allah said in another Ayah, p &S(P&£& ap. 4Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful. (59:20) Allah said here, Sj' C-r*- iOr do those who earn evil deeds think} those who commit and practice evil, jjUgj 4^^ it that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds, in their life and their death?} treat them equally in the present life of the world and in the Hereafter? C&} 4Worst is the judgement that they make.} 'worst is the thought that they have about Us and about Our justice, thinking that We will ever make the pious and the wicked equal in the Hereafter or this life.' At-Tabarani recorded that Shubah said that *Amr bin Murrah narrated that Abu Ad-Duha said that Masrtiq said that Tamlm Ad-Dari once stood in voluntary prayer through the night until the morning only reciting this Ayah, IPS \yZ* ceffi J-Y&i cS }Or do those who earn evil deeds think that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds Allah said in reply: £ '&} iWorst is the judgement that they make.} Allah said, At-Tabar&ni 2 :50

4 iif jZj} Allah has created the heavens and the earth with truths meaning, in justice, "i \1j 0Ji>y iin order that each person may be recompensed what he has earned, and they will not be wronged.} Allah the Exalted said, iZ* fZ1 j*' £ Z'ff} iHave you seen him who takes his own lust as his god?}, who

abides by his lust, and whatever his lust portrays as good he implements it, and whatever his lust portrays as evil, he abandons it! Allah's statement, *ih&^ iAnd Allah left him astray with knowledge,* has two meanings. One of them is that Allah knew that this person deserves to be misguided, so He left him astray. The second meaning is that Allah led this person astray after knowledge reached him and the proof was established before him. The second meaning includes the first meaning, but not the opposite. Allah said, *-j jZj} iand sealed his hearing and his heart, and put a cover on his sight.}* so he does not hear what benefits him, understands not what would lead him to the guidance and sees not the evidence with which he can be enlightened. This is why Allah said, *\$ Z*'.Oi ii-ir. iWho then will guide him after Allah? Will you not then remember?}* Allah said in a similar Ayah, *4 ^ ^Lii £} ^Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgressions.}* (7 : 186).

*} o!% jj Jil;i Cj Cj &, &' (2u Vi ,> C» oi j^st lJ\S oi V| o^" U yiii Gli'» pi j2 lij> 4, U-&I 3^ V*J V ilCli (y> dl jr ^2_d <fl' <24. And they say: "There is nothing but our life of this world, we die and we live and nothing destroys us except Ad- Dahr (time). And they have no knowledge of it, they only presume.) 425. And when Our Clear Ayat are recited to them, their argument is no other than that they say: "Bring back our (dead) fathers, if you are truthful!") 426. Say (to them): "Allah gives you life, then causes you to die, then He will assemble you on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt. But most of mankind know not.") The Conviction of the Disbelievers, Their Argument and the Refutation of it Allah mentions here the creed of Ad-Dahriyyah and the Arab idolators who embraced their creed, denying Resurrection, 4&J C% (2C- VI Jt £ \ij) 4 And they say: "There is nothing but our life of this world, we die and we live....") They say that there is only this life, some people die while others are born to life, without Resurrection or Judgement. This was the creed of Arab idolators who used to deny Resurrection, in addition to, the creed of the atheist philosophers among them who denied the creation and Resurrection. This was also the statement of atheist philosophers who deny the Creator and think that the world will return to its original form once every thirty-six thousand years, when everything will restart its life-cycle again! They claim that this cycle was repeated for infinity, thus contradicting the sound reason and the divine revelation. They said,*

*C> iand nothing destroys us except Ad-Dahr (time).) Allah the Exalted said in reply, iAnd they have no knowledge of it, they only presume.) they speculate and guess! As for the Hadith recorded by the two collectors of the Sahih, and Abu Dawud and An-Nasal, from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jJg said, JJ —L» 1 ijfi I ^ajjl C~Lj •if'do Jjjj» 8 Allah the Exalted says, "Tlte Son of 'Adam annoys Me when he curses Ad-Dahr (time), while I am Ad-Dahr. In My Hand are all matters; I cause the alternation of his days and nights."^ In another narration; «#Ji^ Jli 2)1 Sli ; V •Do /iof curse Ad-Dahr (time), for Allah is Ad-Dahr . »*21 Ash-ShafiT, Abu 'Ubaydah and several other Imams of Tafsir explained the meaning of the Prophet's statement, 'y> ill y>j}\ 1 'jo "Do not abuse Ad-Dahr (time), for Allah is Ad-Dahr .» They said, "During the time of Jahiliyyah, when an affliction, a calamity or a disaster struck them, the Arabs used to say, "Woe to Ad-Dahr {time}!" So they used to blame such incidents on Ad-Dahr, cursing Ad-Dahr in the process. Surely, it is Allah the Exalted and Most Honored Who causes these (and all) things to happen. This is why when they cursed Ad-Dahr, it was as if they were cursing Allah Himself, since truthfully, He causes all incidents to happen. Therefore, abusing Ad-Dahr Path Al-Bari 8 :437, Muslim 4 : 1762, Abu Dawud 5:423, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :457 121 Muslim 4:1763*

was prohibited due to this consideration, for it was Allah Whom they meant by abusing Ad-Dahr, which - as we said- they accused of causing (distressful) incidents.” This is the best explanation for this subject, and it is the desired meaning. Allah knows best. We should mention that Ibn Hazm and those of the Zahiriyyah like him made an error when they used this Hadith to include Ad-Dahr among Allah’s most beautiful Names. Allah’s statement, “And when Our Clear Ayat are recited to them,) means, when the truth is made plain to them and used as evidence against them, asserting that Allah is able to resurrect the bodies after they have perished and disintegrated, “their argument is no other than that they say: “Bring back our fathers, if you are truthful!”) ‘bring them back to life, if what you say is true.’ Allah the Exalted said, “Say (to them): "Allah gives you life and then causes you to die..."") For you are witnesses that He brings you (or new life) to existence after non-existence,” (2:28) Therefore, He Who is able to initiate creation, is able to restart it, as well and more obviously, “And He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him.” (30:27) Allah said next,

33 Surah 45. Al-Jathiyah (24-26) (Part-25) “then He will assemble you on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt.” ‘when He resurrects you, it will be on and for the Day of Resurrection, not in this life. Therefore, your statement is groundless,’ “Bring back our (dead) fathers, if you are truthful!” Allah said, “The Day when He will gather you (all) on the Day of Gathering.” (64:9), “For the Day are these signs postponed? For the Day of sorting out.” (77:12-13), and, “We delay it only for a term (already) fixed.” (11:104) Allah said here, “then He will assemble you on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt.” there is no doubt that it will come, “But most of mankind know not.” and this is why they deny Resurrection and discount the fact that the bodies will be brought back to life. Allah the Exalted said, “Verily, they see it afar off. But We see it (quite) near.” (70:6), they discount the possibility that Resurrection will ever come, while the believers believe that its occurrence is easy and imminent.

35 Surah 45. Al-Jathiyah (27-29) (Part-25) “the followers of falsehood shall lose.” those who disbelieve in Allah and reject the clear proofs and unequivocal evidences that He has sent down to His Messengers. Allah said, “And you will see each nation humbled to their knees (Jathiyah),” kneeling, fearful of the tremendous calamity and events. It was said that this will occur when Hellfire will be brought forth, for she will exhale once, and everyone will fall to their knees, including Ibrahim, the Khalil. He will proclaim, “Myself, myself, myself! Today, I will not ask You (O Allah) but about myself.” And even ‘Isa, will proclaim, “Today, I will only argue before You on my own behalf, I will not ask You about Maryam, who gave birth to me.” Allah said next, “each nation will be called to its Record.” meaning, Record of deeds. Allah said in a similar Ayah, “And the Book will be presented; and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward” (39:69). This is why Allah said here, “This Day you shall be recompensed for what you used to do.” “you will be judged according to your deeds, good and evil.” Allah said in similar Ayah, “On that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind. Nay! Man will be a witness against himself, though he may put forth his excuses.” (75:13-15) Allah said, “This, Our Record speaks about you with truth.” It contains the record of all your actions, without addition or

deletion. Allah also said: y 0)1jip 4-» Ovii -< CJ>v>u3' iS/» silikji' 4; %Uc !)U c ijjL-jS VJ ;J*T£ C*S 4A«d the Book will be presented, and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is therein. They will say: "Woe to us! What sort of Book is this that leaves neitlter a small thing nor a big thing, but has recorded it with numbers!" And they will find all that they did, placed before them, and your Lord treats no one with injustice (18:49) Allah's statement, iVerily, We were recording what you used to do . means, *We ordered Our scribe angels to record your deeds.' Ibn 'Abbas and others commented, "The angels record the deeds of the servants and then ascend to heaven with them. There, they meet the angels entrusted with the Records of deeds sent down from Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz on each Night of Al-Qadr, containing what Allah has written will occur from the servants, long before He created them. They will compare their records and find out that not a single letter was added or deleted." He then recited this Ayah, if&i zt c 'it iVerily, I've were recording what you used to do. # as k ji % & pj f&ti g jg: 'ji '-£> J o*- l*> VJ jti icUJI U <sjs, 6 pi l|Li Cf} V ielil) £vt *bi t 'fc—Z pjif Jj) .f, ij}^ U^ jU) C c&l. fi, ttAi !i>* *4'* & J3 Cj jdii ui 45 yi 46^1 Jj ^ •?;& s&s* V biii <&s\ 4^ iij <30. Then, as for those who believed and did good deeds, their Lord will admit them to His mercy. That will be the evident success.

37Surah 45. Al-Jdthiyah (30-37) (Part-25) 431. But as Jbr those who disbelieved (it will be said to them) : "Were not Our Ayat recited to you? But you were proud, and you were a people who were criminals."} 432. And when it was said: "Verily, Allah's promise is the truth, and there is no doubt about the coming of the Hour," you said: "We knoiu not what is the Hour: we do not think it but conjecture, and we have no firm convincing belief (therein)."} 433. And the evil of what they did will appear to them, and that which they used to mock at will completely encircle them.} 434. And it will be said: "This Day We will forget you as you forgot the meeting of this Day ofyours . And your abode is the Fire, and there is none to help you."} 435. This, because you took the revelations of Allah in mockery, and the life of the world deceived you. So this Day, they shall not be taken outfrom there (Hell), nor shall they be returned to the worldly life.} 436. So all praise is due to AUSH, the Lord of the heavens and the Lord of the earth, and the Lord ofall that exists.} 437. And His is the majesty in the heavens and the earth, and He is Al-'Azlz, Al-Hakim.} Allah states to us His judgement in His creation on the Day of Resurrection, ijuij \jSxi (X} iThen, asfor those who believed and did good deeds,} Those whose hearts believed and their limbs performed good deeds, in sincerity to Allah and conforming with Islamic legislation; 4 *&&} itheir Lord will admit them to His mercy.} and that is Paradise. In the Sahih, Allah said to Paradise; *JLi(id; i ,_£*»•j «"Yon areMy mercy, with which I grant mercy to whom I will,"*111 111 PathAl-B&ri8 :460

39Surah 45. Al-ldthiuh (30-37) (Part-25 iattd will completely encircle them.} from all directions, 4i>vr-i -ft ^} ithat which they used to mock at} of the coming torment and punishment, iAnd it will be said: "This Day We will forget you..."} We will treat you as if We have forgotten you, casting you in the fire of Jahannam,' %} 4as you forgot the meeting of this Day ofyours.} 'and did not work for it because you did not believe in its coming,' 4And your abode is the Fire, and there is none to help you.} In the Sahih, it is reported that Allah the Exalted will ask some of His servants on the Day of Resurrection, yri *j/sjo j£ii iu^ ^ ! Uj <il J ^ iu C . .lad : . —Jj Lj jJL ! (J^Ls • «£_J US' dldt ;*Ju ""Have I not given you a spouse, honored you and subjected the camels and horses to you? Have I not allowed you to be a chiefand a master?" The servant will say in answer, "Yes, O Lord!" Allah will say, "Did you think that

you would ever meet Me?" He will say, "No." Allah the Exalted will say, "then this Day, I will forget you as you forgot Allah the Exalted said, 4& -if Mm iThis, because you took the revelations of Allah in mockery.} m Muslim 4 :2279

40 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr *We gave you this punishment as retribution because you mocked Allah's proofs that He sent to you, and made them the subject of jokes and jest,' i<md the life of the world deceived you .} 'this life fooled you and you were seduced by to it, thus becoming among the ultimate losers,' iSo this Day, they shall not be taken out from there}, from Hellfire, inor shall they be returned to the worldly life.} no apologies shall be sought from them, but they will be punished without limit or delay, just as a group of the believers will enter Paradise without limit or delay. After Allah mentioned His judgement for the believers and the disbelievers, He said, yyj yj xil *&} iSo all praise is due to Allah, the Lord of the heavens and the Lord of the earth,} He is their Owner and the Owner of all that is in and on them, and surely, iand the Lord of all that exists.} Allah said next, 6 4 iZJOi %} 4And His is the majesty in the heavens and the earth,} meaning, the kingship, according to Mujahid. This Ayah means, Allah is the Almighty, Worthy of all praise; everything and everyone is subservient and in complete need of and dependent upon Him. In an authentic Hadith, the Prophet ^ said, if** j! ill

41Surah 45. Al-Idthiyah (30-37) (Part-25 vAllah the Exalted said, "Glory is My robe and pride is My garment; whoever rivals Me for either of them, I will make him reside in My Fire/"#11 * Muslim collected a similar Hadith.'2| Allah said, iand He is the Al-'Aziz,} Who is never resisted or rivaled, iAl-Halim} all wise in His statements, actions, legislation and the decree that He appoints; all glory and praise are due to Him, none has the right to be worshipped but He, Alone.

Surah 46: Al-Ahqaf

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Ahqdf

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(Chapter - 46) Which was revealed in Makkah S nmm ° • y r\ ^3p ilj© \$ ofjV(j gf as&«f% o& Or- £>iJ'j i^*J }0 \Jt ~fC^=o\jSc;^j*yjS\jlvj^tojj5^ji_i^l(jjiiT ^p Up£jz*^Ac^ JS-^ljS) dl.ta)f^yC^Sf /n the Name of Allah the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. » * # ©;»> ck c *s n Ej? c; J.J/5 vjffli \ ' *s*A * * m> > - 1 ^ P^j' J» Jjiil liU 4ul OJA c^J o^~C vS^' 4 4/S jwi fl ,> J^ ^Ai* Jo Cj*. i^>*^ JjIjI -*4 >-1^ ^ J-3.1 & > :'' vf - ^ j t- .«g A 3 jJ- 4l»> OJA oj J*-*- ^ i2j\ /y44 ^ 'j^5 iijf (*£»&* !*@ •-'*1 41 . Ha Mim.\$ 42 . 77ie revelation of the Book is from Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise.» 43. We created not the heavens and the earth and all that is

43Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (1-6) (Part-26) between them except with truth, and for a specified term. But those who disbelieve, turn away from that whereof they are warned.} 44 . Say: "Think you about all that you invoke besides Allah? Show me what have they created of the earth? Or have they a share in (the creation of) the heavens? Bring me a scripture prior to this or some trace of knowledge, if you are truthful!"} 45- And who is more astray than those who invoke besides Allah others who will not answer them until the Day of Resurrection, and who are unaware of their invocations to them?} 46. And when mankind are gathered, they (false deities) will become their enemies and will deny their worship.} The Qur'an is a Revelation from Allah and the Universe is His True Creation Allah informs that He has revealed the Book to His servant and Messenger Muhammad - may Allah's blessings be upon him until the Day of Judgement. Allah then describes Himself as being of unimaginable glory, possessing ultimate wisdom in His statements and actions. Allah then says, 4Ei VI Cj <2L C} 4We created not the heavens and the earth and all that is between them except in truth,} meaning, not in idle play and falsehood. 4andfor a specified term.} meaning, for a fixed and specified duration that will not increase or decrease. Allah continues, lli Zr&j} 4But those who disbelieve, turn away from that of which they are warned.} Meaning, the disbelievers are distracted from what is intended for them. Allah has indeed revealed to them a Book and sent to them a Messenger. Yet, they obstinately turn away from all

of that. Therefore, they will soon realize the consequence of their behavior. Refuting the Idolators Allah then says, 4Say} meaning, to these idolators who worship others besides Allah. iy\ ijili- ojj cti U &\$} iThink you about all that you invoke besides Allah? Show me what they have created of the earth?'} (46:4) meaning, 'show me the place that they have independently created from the earth.' 4 jtf ft iOr have they a share in the heavens?} which means that they are not partners in anything in the heavens, nor on earth. They do not own even the thin membrane covering a date's pit. The dominion and control only belong to Allah, Exalted is He. 'How then would you worship others or join them as partners with Him? Who guided you to that? Who called you to that? Did He command you to do it, or is it

something that you suggested yourselves?’ Thus, He says, Jj i yiy^} 4Bring me a scripture prior to this} meaning, ‘bring a book from among the Books of Allah that have been revealed to the Prophets, that commands you to worship these idols.’ \$} 4or some trace ofknowledge,} meaning, ‘some clear evidence justifying this way you have chosen.’

45Surah 46. Al-Ahqdf (1-6) (Part-26) ifyou are truthful!} meaning, “you have absolutely no evidence for that - neither textual (from revelation) nor rational.’ For this reason, some recited it; <p-4 Si 3^ “or something inherited from knowledge” meaning, ‘or true knowledge that you have inherited from anyone before you.’ This is similar to Mujahid’s statement when he said, <Ji)j\$ fy ior some trace ofknowledge “Or anyone who has inherited any knowledge.” Allah then says, o* (v»> j—’4!* -tx. V ja> Ojj Jt *»*** j-; J—d 4And w/jo is wore astray tlmn those who invokes besides Allah others who will not answer them until the Day of Resurrection, and who are unaware of their invocations to them?} meaning, no one is more misguided than those who invoke idols instead of Allah, asking them for things that they cannot give - until the Day of Judgment. They (the idols) are unaware of what he asks, they can neither hear, see, or act. This is because they are inanimate, senseless stones. Allah then says, ^ \ \$ J.&A iAnd when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worship.} This is similar to Allah’s saying: -* 3-^ 4-i* ex } iThey have taken gods beside Allah, that they might give them dignity. No! They will deny their worship of them, and will be opponents to them.} (19:81, 82) m At-Tabari 22 :94

47Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (7-9) (Part-26) you! And He is the Oft-Forgmng, the Most Merciful."} 49. Say: "I am not a new thing among the Messengers , nor do I know what will be done with me or you. I only follow that which is revealed to me, and Iam but a plain wamer."} Refuting Claims of the Idolaters about the Qur’an and the Messenger\$ Concerning the disbelief and rebellion of the idolaters, Allah says that when the clear Ayat of Allah are recited to them they say; 04^ 477iis is plain magic!} meaning, simple magic. In this statement of theirs, they have lied, invented a falsehood, went astray and disbelieved. iiss 4Or they say: “He hasfabricated it.” } They are referring to Muhammad Allah responds saying, iSay: “If I havefabricated it, you have no power to support me against Allah...”} which means, ‘if I lie against Allah and falsely claim that He sent me when He actually had not, then He would punish me with a severe punishment. No one on the earth - you or anyone else - would then be able to protect me from Him.’ It is similar to Allah’s saying, Og&jj 4 j* lii 7) .Ajjj oi '4 4 Si 4f. S' 4Soy: "None can protect me from Allah, nor would I find a refuge except in Him. (My duty) is only to convey from Allah and (deliver) His Messages.”} (72:22-23) Allah says, a j£* a Jis <&t p (§&& 4 g& (g^Vi iAnd if he made up a false saying concerning Us, \Ne surely

would have seized him by the right hand. Then we would have ait offhis life artery. And none ofyou could withhold Usfrom (punishing) him.) (69:44-47) Thus, Allah says here, d£i ’-St- W -»*6 ' £- ^S«y: "/" I have fabricated it, still you have no power to support me against Allah. He knows best of what you say among yourselves concerning it (i.e. this Qur’an)! Sufficient is He as a witness between me and you!...”} This is a severe threat, intimidation find warning for them. Allah then says, %} }And He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful.} This is an encouragement for them to repent and turn to Allah. It means, ‘despite all of this, if you turn back and repent, Allah will accept your repentance, pardon you, forgive you, and have mercy upon on.’ This is similar to Allah’s saying in Surat Al-Furqan, ji (n£; // 'J tr

And they say : "(This Book is) legends of the ancients that he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon." Say: "It has been sent down by the One Who knows every secret within the heavens and the earth . Truly, He is ever Forgiving and Merciful." } (25:5-6) Allah then says, Si t\$} iSay: "I am not a new thing among the Messengers..." } which means, "I am not the first Messenger who ever came to the world. Rather, Messengers came before me. Therefore, I am not an unprecedented incident that should cause you all to reject me and doubt my being sent to you. Indeed, Allah has sent before me all of the Prophets to various nations.'

Allah then says, 4%% ±& C 4«or do I know what will be done with me or with you.} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "It (this Ayah) was followed in revelation by, 4'j& u iii iSa 4That Allah may forgive for you your sins of the past and future}.^ Similarly, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, and Qatadah all said that this Ayah was abrogated by the Ayah; i'jk Cj « fSS C&& jQ) iThat Allah may forgive for you your sins of the past and future}. They said that when the latter Ayah was revealed, one of the Muslims said to Allah's Messenger "Allah has declared what He will do for you. But what will He do for us?" Then Allah revealed; 4fr^^ Jiff SiQ} 4Tlwt He may admit the believing men and the believing women to Gardens under which rivers flow}. This is what they said. That which has been confirmed in the Sahih is that the believers said, "May you enjoy that, O Allah's Messenger! But what do we get?" So Allah revealed this AyahJ3 I Imam Ahmad recorded that Kharijah bin Zayd bin Thabit, reported that Umm Al-'Ala' - a woman from the Ansar who had given her pledge of loyalty to Allah's Messenger sg£ - said, "When the Ansar drew lots regarding taking in the Muhajirun to dwell with them, our lot was to have TJthman bin Maz'un. Later, TJthman fell sick in our house, so we nursed him until he died, and we wrapped him in his garments (for burial). 111 At-Tabarl 22:99. 121 At-Tabari 22:99,100. 131 FathAl-Bari 7:516.

Allah's Messenger 0 then came in, and I said, 'O Abu As- Sa'ib! May Allah have mercy on you. I bear witness that Allah has indeed honored you.' Allah's Messenger jg asked, 2>1 \ siLjX Uj» iHow do you know that Allah has honored him? I said, 1 do not know - may my father and mother both be ransoms for you!' Allah's Messenger sg then said, "cfi ^ 5" "As far him, certainty (death) has reached him from his Lord, and I surely wish wellfar him. But by Allah, even though I am Allah's Messenger, I do not know what will happen to me (after death). I then said, 'Never will I claim a person to be pious after this.' This incident caused me some distress, and I went to sleep thereafter. I saw in my dream that TJthman owned a running water spring. I went to Allah's Messenger 0 and told him about that. Allah's Messenger jg said, *That was his (good) deeds Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith but Muslim did not. In one of the narrations, Allah's Messenger0 said, L* liij iEven though I am Allah's Messenger, I do not know what will happen to him. This and similar texts indicate that it is not allowed to declare that a specific person will enter Jannah except for those who were distinctly indicated by Allah or his Messenger 0. Examples of those are the Ten, 131 Ibn Sallam, Al- 111 Ahmad 6 :436 and Fath Al-B&ri 7 :310. (2 > Fath Al-Bari3:137. They are: Abu Bakr , Umar, Uthman, 'Ali, Talhah, Az-Zubayr, 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf, Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas, Said bin Zayd, and Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah

51Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (10-14) (Part-26) Ghumaysa', ' Bilal, Suraqah, 'Abdullah bin 'Amr bin Haram (Jabir's father), the Seventy Recitors (of Qur'an) who were assassinated near the Well of Ma'Qnah, Zayd bin Harithah, Jafar, Ibn Rawahah, and other similar individuals, may Allah be pleased with them.

Allah then says, Sri 6 ^1 9'^ il only follow that which is revealed to which means, 1 only follow what Allah has revealed to me of the revelation.' iand 1 am but a plain wamer.) meaning, 'my warnings are obvious to every person with sound intellect and reason.' And Allah knows best. Jc j; x# 02 OaLi. ifrJ ' *i fj& i"" 02 o) fjji- ifa \$ 1 \fji£=z OjJl Jlij pi)l ^J-r. 'I (-JsJj s j, > 'S' •; ^ X< " " K K'" - x >' m\ C ">| 1 Zf*j* *4j \j£~4j p ^ '1-lvSfr.j**-*^ (&-4j o;4* tiy* UCj jo-** v—C 'joy dll) 4^*^ jbljl jii Vj Vi iji'j:!' p ill bij ijltt u;iil ot q 4)^ 410. Say: "Tell me! If it was from Allah and you disbelieved it, (at the same time), a witness from among the Children of Israel has testified to something similar and believed while you rejected (the truth)!" Verily, Allah does not guide the wrongdoing people. ill. And those who disbelieve say of those who believe: "Had it been a good thing, they (the poor believers) would not have preceded us to it!" And when they have not been guided by it, they say: "This is ancientfalsehood!" } i!2. And before this was the Scripture ofMusa as a guide and 01 Better known asUmm Sulaym, may Allah be pleased with her. She is the mother ofAnas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with them.

a mercy. And this is a Book confirming in the Arabic tongue, to warn those who do wrong, and as glad tidings for the doers ofgood.} 413. Verily, those who say: "Our Lord is (only) Allah," and thereafter stand firm, on them shall be no fear, nor shall they grieve.} 414. Such shall be the dwellers of Paradise, abiding therein (forever) - a rewardfor what they used to do.} The Qur'an is Allah's True Speech and the Position of the Disbelievers and the Muslims towards it Allah says, 4Say} meaning, 'O Muhammad to these idolaters who disbelieve in the Qur'an.' 4bt oj 2:1} iTell me! If it was} meaning, this Qur'an. 0§ bt} ifrom Allah, and you disbelieved in it?} meaning, "what do you think that Allah will do to you if this Book that I have come to you with is actually revealed to me from Him in order that I convey it to you, and yet you disbelieve in it and deny it?" 4^4i& z\$ J>i 2*6ig} 4(at the same time), a witness from among the Children of Israel has testified to something similar} meaning, the previous Scriptures that were revealed to the Prophets before me all testify to its truthfulness and authenticity. They have prophecied, well in advance, about things similar to that which this Qur'an informs of.' Concerning Allah's statement, 4(1& } 4and believed} this person who testified to its truthfulness from the Children of Israel, due to his realization that it was the truth.'

55Surah 46. Al-Ahcjaf (10-14) (Part-26) they have not left off any of the good characteristics except that they hurried to perform them." Allah continues, 4And when they have not been guided by it,} meaning, the Qur'an. 'i* jjijulZ} ithey say : "This is an ancientfalsehood!" } meaning, an old lie. They mean by this that the Qur'an has been quoted and taken from the ancient people, thereby belittling the Qur'an and its followers. This is clear arrogance, as Allah's Messenger said: ^ (Arrogance is) rejecting the truth and belittling thepeopled Allah then says, iAnd before this was the Scripture ofMusa} and it was the Tawrah. ias a guide and mercy. And this is a Book} meaning, the Qur'an. 4confirming^ meaning, that which came before it of the previous Books. 4in the Arabic tongue,} means that it is eloquent and clear. ito warn those who do wrong, and as glad tidings for the doers ofgood.} meaning, it contains a warning to the dis- believers and glad Recorded by Muslim 1 :93

57Surah 46. Al-Ahaaf (15-16) (Part-26) il5. And We have enjoined on man to be dutiful and kind to his parents. His mother bears him with hardship. And she delivers him with hardship. And (the period of) his gestation and the weaning of him is thirty months, till when he attains fidl strength and reachesforty

years, he says : “My Lord! Grant me the power and ability that I may be grateful for Your favor which You have bestowed upon me and upon my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds, such as please You, and make my offspring good. Truly, I have turned to You in repentance, and truly, I am one of the Muslims.”} 416. They are those from whom We shall accept the best of their deeds and overlook their evil deeds. (They shall be) among the dwellers of Paradise. That is a promise of truth that they had been promised.} Allah’s Advice about the Parents After mentioning that one must confess His Oneness, worship Him with sincerity, and remain upright in obeying Him, Allah follows that by giving instructions regarding the parents. These appear together in many places of the Qur’an, such as Allah’s saying, ‘Your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him, and that you be dutiful to your parents.’ (17:23) Allah says, ‘Be grateful to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination.’ (31:14) There are many other Ayat like this as well. Here Allah says, ‘And We have enjoined on man to be dutiful and kind to his parents.’ (46:15) meaning, ‘We have commanded him to treat them well and show compassion towards them. Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded from Sa’d bin Abi Waqqas, may Allah be pleased with him, that his mother said to him: “Hasn’t Allah commanded

Surah 46. Al-Ahqdf (15-16) (Part-26) ‘The mothers suckle their children two complete years - far those who desire to complete the term of suckling.’ (2:233) This is a strong and valid conclusion, and it was approved by Tjthmfin and a number of the Companions. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar * narrated from Ba’jah bin ‘Abdullah Al-Juhanl that a man from his tribe (Juhaynah) married a woman from Juhaynah. She delivered a baby after six months. So her husband went to Tjthman, may Allah be pleased with him, and told him about that. Thus, Uthman summoned her. When she was getting dressed, her sister started crying. She asked her: “Why do you cry? By Allah, no one has ever approached me (for sexual relations) of Allah’s creation except him (my husband). So let Allah decree (for me) as He wills.” When she was brought before Tjthman, he commanded that she be stoned to death (for adultery). ‘All heard of this, came to Tjthman, and said: “What are you doing?” He (Tjthman) said: “She delivered after six months! Can this ever happen?” ‘All, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “Don’t you read the Qur’an?” He said: “Yes, of course!” He (‘AH) then said: haven’t you heard Allah’s saying, ‘and his gestation and weaning is thirty months’, and; ‘two complete years’ (2:233) (Subtracting the two numbers) we are only left with six months.” Tjthman, may Allah be pleased with him, said: “By Allah, I did not see that! Bring the woman back.” But they found that she had already been killed. Bajah continued: “By Allah, no two crows and no two eggs are more similar than that child turned out to be to his father! When his father saw that he said, “By Allah! This is my son without any doubt.’ Later on, Allah afflicted him with a skin abscess in his face (because of his false accusation to his wife). It kept eating him up until he died.”¹²¹ ^ This narration is not authentically transmitted. Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Al-Mundhir according to Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :9 . As stated above , this is a weak narration

Ibn Abi Hatim related from his father that Farwah bin Abi Al- Maghra’ told them that ‘All bin Mushir narrated to them from Dawud bin Abi Hind, who narrated from Ikrimah that Ibn ‘Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “When a woman delivers after nine months, the baby will only need twenty-one months of suckling. When she delivers after seven months, the baby will need twenty-three months of suckling. When she delivers after six months, the baby will need two full years of suckling, because

Allah says, *lii £ \$and his gestation and weaning is thirty months, till when he attainsfull strengthK* meaning, he becomes strong, youthful, and attains full ability. *ia*nd reaches*forty* years, meaning, his complete intellect, understanding, and patience reach the level of maturity. It has also been said that usually one will not change his ways once he reaches the age of forty. *i*he says : "My Lord! Grant me the power and ability^ meaning, 'inspire me.' *do&£3\$ fr i*that I may be grateful for Your favor which You have bestowed upon me and upon my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds, such as please You,*}* meaning, in the future. *ia*nd make my offspring good.*}* meaning, my offspring and descendants. *Ji Hi £3 4l^ i*Truly, I have turned to You in repentance, and truly, I am m Al-Bayhaqi 7:332.

"This is nothing but the legends of the ancient."} 418 . They are those against whom the Word (of torment) has justified among the previous generations of Jinn and mankind that have passed away. Verily, they are ever the losers .} 419. And for all, there will be degrees according to that which they did, so that He might fully recompense for their deeds. And they will not be wronged.} 420. On the Day when those who disbelieve will be exposed to the Fire (it will be said) : "You received your good things in the life of the world, and you took your pleasure therein . Today, you will be recompensed with the torment of extreme humiliation, because you were arrogant upon the earth without a right, and because you used to rebel against Allah's command.} Mention of*the Undutiful Children and TheirEnd* In the previous Ay&t, Allah mentions the dutiful offspring who supplicate for their parents and treat them with kindness. He describes the success and salvation He has prepared for them. Here He connects to that discussion the situation of the wretched offspring who are undutiful toward their parents. Allah says, 4*But he who says to his parents : "Uff to you! ..."*} As for the saying "Uff" in this Ayah, it is a general description applying to anyone who says it to his parents. Some people claim that it was revealed about 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr. But this claim is weak and rejected, because 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr embraced Islam after this was revealed. His adherence to Islam was excellent, and he was among the best of his contemporaries. Al-Bukhari recorded from Yusuf bin Mahak that Marwan (bin Al-Hakam) was governor of Hijaz (Western Arabia), appointed by Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan. He (Marwan) delivered a speech in which he mentioned Yazid bin Mu'awiyah and urged the people to give a pledge of allegiance after his father. 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr said something to him in response to that, upon which Marwan commanded

63*Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (17-20) (Part-26)* his men: "Arrest him!" But he entered 'Aishah's house, and they were not able to capture him. Marwan then said: "This is the one about whom Allah revealed: 4*But he who says to his parents: "Uff to you! Do you promise me that I will be raised - when generations before me have passed?"*y From behind the curtain, 'Aishah responded: "Allah did not reveal any Qur'an in our regard (i.e. the children of Abu Bakr), except for the declaration of my innocence."111 In another report recorded by An-Nasal, Muhammad bin Ziyad reported that when Mu'awiyah was soliciting people to pledge allegiance to his son, and Marwan declared: "This follows the tradition of Abu Bakr and TJmar." On hearing this, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakr said: "Rather, this is the tradition of Heraclius and Caesar." Marwan responded: "This is the one about whom Allah revealed, i*But he who says to his parents: "Uff to you!"*y When that was conveyed to A'ishah, she said: "Marwan is lying! By Allah, that was not revealed about him. If I wish to name the person meant by it, I could. On the other hand, Allah's Messenger s* placed a curse on Marwan's father (Al- Hakam bin Abi Al-As

when Marwan was still in his loins, so Marwan (bin Al-Hakam) is an outcome of Allah's curse. As for Allah's statement: 4Do you promise me that I will be raised meaning, resurrected. / r# > // #//v iwhen generations before me have passed?} meaning, generations of people have already passed away, and Path Al-B&ri 8 :439 . She was referring to SuratAn-Nur24 : 1 1 - 18 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :458

none ofthem has ever returned to tell (what happened to them)? £-1 iWhile they invoke Allahfor help meaning, they ask Allah to guide him, and they say to their son, ^ Ui U Jji-i J»- Mj <j[i"Woe to you! Believe! Verily, the protmise of Allah is true." But he says : "This is nothing but the legends of the ancient."} Allah then says, \$£=> pr) o; at Ji /' 4& 0»- 3.J' ^3^ iThey are those against whom the Word (of torment) has justified among the previous generations of Jinn and mankind that have passed away.Verily, they are ever the losers.} This indicates that all such people will be among their likes and their peers among the disbelievers, who will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. Allah's saying, i^S} 4Those are} after He said, 436 i£&j} iBut he who says } confirms what we have mentioned above that the latter is a general description of a type of people including all those who fall under that description. Al-Hasan and Qata- dah both said, "This applies to the disbelieving, sinful person who is undutiful to his parents and who denies resurrec- tion. [1 ' Allah then says, 4(j4^ d-i } iAndfor all, there will be degrees according to that which they did,} meaning that there will be degrees of punishment for each of them according to what they did. At-Jabari 22 : 1 18

iso that He might fully recompense them for their deeds, and they will not be wronged.} which means Allah will not be unjust to them even in the amount of a speck of dust or less. 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: "The levels of the Fire descend, and those of Paradise ascend."111 Allah then says, 4 jsap\$\&p& iOn the Day when those who disbelieve will be exposed to the Fire (it will be said): "You received your good things in the life of the world, and you took your pleasure therein..."} which means that this will be said to them by way of blame and reprimand. The Commander of the faithful, Tjmar bin Al- Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, gave up many of the joys of food and drink and refrained from them while saying, "I am afraid of being like those whom Allah has reproached and condemned by saying, bji 4 iYou received your good things in the life of the world, and you took your pleasure therein}." Abu Mijlaz said: "Some people will lose good deeds that they had in the worldly life, and they will be told, iYou received your good things in the life of the world}." Then Allah says, ip-* 'p ujPp 4 ll»Op 0jj4 \$%} iToday, you loill be recompensed ivith the torment of extreme humiliation, because you were arrogant upon the earth without a right, and becauseyou used to rebel against Allah's command.} which indicates that their punishment will be of a type comparable to their deeds. They enjoyed themselves, were arrogant in their denial of the truth, and were involved in m At-Tabari 22 : 1 19 .

67Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (21-25) (Part-26) the first people of 'Ad who inhabited Al-Ahqaf. Ahqaf is plural of Haqf. According to Ibn Zayd, it means a sand dune; 111 and according to 'Ikrimah, it means a mountain or a cave. Qatadah said: "We were informed that 'Ad was a tribe in Yemen. They dwelt among sand (hills), and overlooked the sea in a land called Ash-Shihr." Under the chapter, "He Who supplicates should first mention Himself," Ibn Majah recorded that Ibn 'Abbas narrated that

the Prophet jg said: IjU 4)1 "May Allah have mercy on us and the Brother of 'Ad. Allah then says, iAnd surely, wamers had already passed on before him and after him.} meaning, Allah had sent Messengers

and wamers to the towns surrounding the land of 'Ad. This is similar to Allah's saying, iAnd We made it a deterrent punishment for those who were present and those who succeeded them.} (2:66) And it is also similar to Allah's saying, iBut if they turn away, then say : "I have warned you of a thunderbolt like the thunderbolt that struck 'Ad and Thamud. (That occurred) when the Messengers had come to them from before them and after them (saying) : "Worship none but Allah."} (41 :13-14) Allah then says, 111 At-Jaban 22:125. 121 At-Tabarl 22:124. 131 Abu DAwud no. 3984, and Ibn Majah 2:1266. Al-Albani graded this tiadtth weak. Al-Busayri said that it is Sahth.

68 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir itruly, Ifearfar you the torment ofa mighty Day> meaning, Hud said this to them (his people), and they responded to him saying, iHave you come to delude usfrom our gods?} meaning, to prevent us. 4from our gods?} iThen bring us that with which you threaten us, ifyou are one of the truthful!} They sought to hasten Allah's torment and punishment, believing that it will not happen. This is similar to Allah's saying, iThose who do not believe in it (the Last Hour) seek to hasten it} (42:18). Hud's response was, if it jjjf Ql 4He said: "The knowledge (of that) is only with Allah."} which means, 'Allah knows best about you. If you deserve the punishment to be hastened, He will do that to you. As for me, my duty is to deliver my message to you.' 4But I see that you are a people given to ignorance!} which means, you have no comprehension or understanding.' Allah then says, 4Then, when they saw it as a dense cloud approaching their valleys,} meaning, when they saw the punishment coming towards them, they thought it to be clouds full of rain. That made them happy and joyful, because they had a drought and

become happy, hoping that they bring them rain. But I notice that when you see them, displeasure appears on your face." Allah's Messenger jg replied, ij'J -bj (J* jj i jj j (jf l» lAwlp U® • ^jJ>jIp IJLs, Oli*jl JO 'A'ishah! What would guarantee to me that they do not bring punishment? Some nations had been punished with wind. On seeing the punishment approaching them, a nation once said: "This is a cloud bringing us rain."*111 This is also recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said that when Allah's Messenger jg saw clouds on any of the horizons, he would leave whatever he was doing - even if he was in prayer - and say: 'ft? ^ 'j* <&. j>\ «0 Allah! I seek refuge with you from any harm that it (the cloud) contains .» If Allah removed those clouds, the Prophet jg would praise Allah, and if rain fell, he would say: Ci ^ili. «0 Allah! Make it pouring and beneficentJ121 Muslim also recorded in his SahOi from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that when the wind blew, Allah's Messenger 3g would say, ' j*" iji 'ft vlutit ^1 «ft ci-il U iiy U •O Allah! I ask You of its good, the good that it contains, and the good with which it has been sent. And I seek refuge in You from its evil, the evil that it contains, and the evil with which it has been sent.» She added that if the sky became cloudy, his color would Ahmad 6 :66, Fath Al-Bari 8 :441 , and Muslim 2:616. 121 Ahmad 6:190.

71Surah 46. Al-Ahaaf (26-28) (Part-26 V wmmS change; he would exit, . \C\ . O'dn, enter> come, and go. when it rained, his anxiety would be llili biy 'j!^ 'A'ishah, may Allah be h~; 0 asked him about it >>, A* .'site- A i -i< \''V\ \i 311(1 he said: ' *' . , a *J 3l3 aJLjIp Li ^^ ijli £g> ;,U A-i 1.IX il'i tit' ((0 'A'ishah! It could be life toJwf tlle people o/ . - - >>- 'A<^te.'As}' 'Ad said, iThen, when they saw it as a dense JjjJ(& jvr c/owd approaching their ' > -'A" \<sUT"" >/*\ - ^V"TWv'ul valleys, they said. This is a cioud bringing us ai'jli'O-i' ram/'>>» ^/AVi"->tW' 6"~ j 1* fc We have Previously mentioned the

story of the destruction of the people of 'Ad in both Surat Al-A'raf and Surah Hud. Thus, there is no need to repeat it here; and verily Allah is worthy of all praise and gratitude. {t\ 'Ci ijji} ££*!> £' \$ *3*ij tet <jl t-i <*\$ \5 ^ 3£j Jii lyt ij, } & ot pv-*? (*+**' fg)oj£\$5A *S?f SJij^ o# J3£ C CS3*i Jag •% Cj ^£1* ij-i j? jif iUi Oi OM5' (**->“ Xi^ a-- ->it""crr * Muslim 2:616. I2 ' See volume four, the Tafslr of Surat Al-A'raf\7 :65-721, and volume five, the Tafslrof SurahHud (1 1 :50 - 60]

72 Tafstr Ibn KathTr426. And indeed We had firmly established them with that wherewith We have not established you! We also gave them hearing, vision, and hearts. But their hearing, vision, and hearts availed them nothing since they used to deny the Aydt of Allah, and they were completely encircled by that which they used to ridicule!} 427. And indeed We have destroyed toivns round about you, and We have shown (them) the signs in various ivays so that they might return. 428. As for those whom they had taken for gods besides Allah, as the means of approach to Him, why then did they not aid them? Nay, but they vanished completelyfrom them. And that was theirfalsehood, and what they werefabricating.} Allah says, We have granted the earlier nations wealth and offspring in the worldly life. That which We granted them, we did not give you anything similar or close to it.' Furthermore, 4We also gave them hearing, vision, and hearts. But their hearing, vision, and hearts availed them nothing when they used to deny Allah's signs, and they were completely encircled by that which they used to ridicule!} meaning, they were encircled by the torment and exemplary punishment that they denied and whose occurrence they doubted. This means, you listeners must beware of being like them lest a punishment similar to theirs strikes you in this life and the Hereafter. Allah then says, 4&i\ & jjp c isa 4And indeed We have destroyed towns round about you,} This is addressed to the people of Makkah. Allah destroyed the nations who disbelieved in the Messengers who lived aroundMakkah, such as 'Ad who were at Al-Ahqaf in Hadramawt near Yemen, Thamud whose dwellings were between Makkah andAsh-Sham (Greater Syria), Saba' who were in Yemen, the people of Madyan who were on the route and passage to Ghazzah (Western Palestine), and the people of Lut who dwelt

73Sarah 46. Al-Ahqaf (29-32) (Part-26) by the lake (the Dead Sea) which they used to pass by (on the way to Jordan) as well. Allah then says, 4^0* i 4and We have shown (them) the signs in various ways} meaning, *We explained and clarified them.' 4 aIAJ* CIJt «Ll jjJ Ji ijji (4^^ 4so that perhaps they might return . As for those whom they had taken far gods besides Allah, as the means of approach to Him, why then did they not aid them? meaning, did they help them when they were in the greatest need for them? 4i& ijb, j# 4but they vanished completelyfrom them.} Rather, they completely left them alone when they needed them the most. i'r&l^ 4And that was theirfalsehood,} meaning, their lie. 4and what they were fabricating.} which means that they fabricated lies by taking them as gods, and they lost and failed in their worship of them and their reliance upon them - and Allah knows best. Ijjj lilt ijili lilt i A, ir" ^1 'faty ojja '*4-a4 (scy A, oejA-* jl .Aj tyuLj Aut "" iiA 4 Jli Jif jfi Zy-. 'J J»j .yffa) '-ffa* A. A 4j?(J'C t* j liLsSji »U)1 *£>•> Oi 4 429. Ami (remember) when We sent toward you a group of the Jinn, to listen to the Qur'an. When they attended it, they said: "Listen quietly!" And when it was concluded, they returned to their people, as wamers.} 430. They said: "O our people! Verily, we have heard a Book

74 Tafslr Ibn Kathir sent down after Musa, confirming what came before it, it guides to the truth and to the straight path."} "O our people! Respond to Allah's Caller, and believe in him. He (Allah) will

forgive you some of your sins, and protect you from a painful torment."} 432. "And whosoever does not respond to Allah's Caller, he cannot escape on earth, and he will not have besides Allah any protectors. Those are in manifest error."} The Story of the Jinns listening to the Qur'an Imam Ahmad recorded from Az-Zubayr that he commented on the Ayah-, SCJ-ih if} 4 And (remember) when We sent towards you a group of the Jinn, to listen to the Qur'an.} "They were at a place called Nakhlah* 11 while Allah's Messenger jg was performing the Tsha' prayer, and 4&& \&} 4 they crowded on top of each other to hear him.} (72: 19)" Sufyan said, "They stood on top of each other like piled wool."121 Ahmad was alone in recording this. Imam Ahmad and the famous Imam, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi in his book Dala'il An-Nubuwwah, both recorded that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Allah's Messenger ^ never recited Qur'an to the Jinns, nor did he see them. Allah's Messenger ig was heading with a group of his Companions towards the 'Ukaz market. At that time, the devils had been prevented from eavesdropping on the news of the heavens, and they were being attacked by burning flames (whenever they tried to listen). When the devils went back to their people, they asked them what happened to them, and they answered, "We have been prevented from eavesdropping on the news of the heavens, and burning flames now attack us.' Their people told * Nakhlah is the name of a valley located between Makkah and At- T&'if 121 Ahmad 1:167.

75 Surah 46. Al-Ahqdf(29-32) (Part-26 them, 'You have only been prevented from eavesdropping on the information of the heavens because of something (major) that has happened. So go all over the earth, east and west, and see what is it that has obstructed you from eavesdropping on the news of the heavens.' Thus they traveled all over the earth, east and west, seeking that which had obstructed them from eavesdropping on the news of the heavens. A group of them went towards Tihamah, * and found Allah's Messenger jg while he was at a place called Nakhlah along the way to the TJKaz market. He was leading his Companions in the Fajr prayer. When the Jinns heard the recitation of the Qur'an, they stopped to listen to it, and then they said: *By Allah! This is what has prevented you from eavesdropping on the news of the heavens.' Then they returned to their people and told them: 'Our people! We certainly have heard an amazing recitation (the Qur'an), it guides to the right path. So we have believed in it, and we will join none in worship with our Lord.' So Allah revealed to His Prophet jg, iSay: It has been revealed to me that a group of Jinns have listened (to the Qur'an).} (72:19) Thus, what was revealed to him was only the saying of the Jinns. ""2 ' Al-Bukhari recorded a similar narration, and Muslim recorded it (as it is here). At-Tirmidhi also recorded it, as did An-Nasal in his Ta/str.'31 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud reported that the Jinns came down upon the Prophet jg while he was reciting the Qur'an at a place called Nakhlah. When they heard him, iThey said: "Listen quietly."} meaning, hush! They were nine in number, and one of them was called Zawba'ah. So Allah revealed, ^ A village about seventy-two miles toward the west of Al-Madlnah. Ahmad 1 :252 and Dald'il An-Nubuwwah 2 :225 131 Al-Bukharl no. 773, 4921, Muslim 1 :331 ,Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :168 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra6 :499

JA \Jl, j+ff> jl when We sent toward you a group of Jintts, to listen to the Qur'an. When they attended it, they said: "Listen quietly!" And when it was concluded, they returned to their people as wamers4 until His saying: 4^ 4 manifest error . >*"• Thus, this report along with the above one by Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, indicate that Allah's Messenger jg was not aware of the presence of the Jinns at that time. They only listened to his recitation and went back to their people. Later on, they

came to him in groups, one party after another, and one group after another. As for Allah's saying, 4yi>)> 4they returned to their people as warners. It means that they went back to their people and warned them about what they heard from Allah's Messenger jg. This is similar to Allah's saying, 4'£>v& ijLy m >i*ji 4- .that they may obtain understanding in religion and warn their people when they return to them, so that they might be cautious (of evil). (9:122) This Ayah has been used as evidence that the Jinns have warners from among themselves, but no Messengers. There is no doubt that Allah did not send Messengers from among the Jinns, because He says, 4cfJ& Zfz? 'ML* irt Lt—ji 4And We did not send before you as Messengers any but men, to whom We revealed from among the people of cities. Al-Hakim 2 :456

Tawrah, the Tawrah being the reference. That is why they said, "Sent down after Musa." This is also the way that Waraqah bin Nawfal spoke when the Prophet m, told him about his first meeting with Jibril, An-NamOs, peace be upon him. He said: "Very good, very good! This is (the angel) that used to come to MQsa. I wish that I was still a young man (to support you)."111 iconfirming what came before it,} meaning, the Scriptures that were revealed before it to the previous Prophets. They then said, 44*^' 3\ &£} 4it guides to the truth} means in belief and information. iand to the straight path.} which means, in deeds. For verily, the Qur'an contains two things: information and commandments. Its information is true, and its commandments are all just, as Allah says, fc*% 3%S} iAnd the Word of Your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice.} (6:115) Allah says, 44**^ 'jif3 Jb-u SZ'J* y>} ilt is He Who has sent His Messenger with the guidance and the religion of truth.} (9:122) The guidance is the beneficent knowledge, and the religion of truth means the righteous good deeds. Thus, the Jinns said, 44*^ 3[v-ir.b tit guides to the truth} in matters of belief, c£-2 30 111 See Fath Al-Bdri 1 :30 but without the words "Bakh , Bakh" (very good , very good)

79Surah 46. Al-Ahqaf (29-32) (Part-26) iand to the straight path.} meaning, in regard to actions. <0 our people! Respond to Allah's Caller,} This is proof that Muhammad ig has been sent to both the human beings and the Jinns. Thus, Allah says, 4Respond to Allah's Caller and believe in him.} Then Allah says, <& ig f5U5 <He will then forgive you some of your sins,} Some scholars say that "some" here is auxiliary, but this is questionable since it is rarely used to strengthen an affirmative meaning. Others say that it means partial forgiveness. lit iand protect you from a painful torment.} meaning, He will protect you from His painful punishment. Then Allah informs that they said, j \$ If)* v-f. ^ i 4And whosoever does not respond to Allah's Caller, he cannot escape on earth,} meaning, Allah's power encompasses him and surrounds him. iand he will not have besides Allah any protectors.} meaning, no one can protect him against Allah. iThose are in manifest error.} This is a threat and warning. Thus, those Jinns called their people with encouragement and warning. Because of this, many of the Jinns took heed and came to Allah's Messenger jg in successive delegations; and verily, Allah is worthy of all praise and gratitude, and Allah knows best.

80 Tafisir Ibn Kathir jr ussmz **> Tf mxmm Ilia OrL?^-*&£<\$•)\$-> IS*xfoa>- "f. <***Si ^ t ^ i v £ 2h<£>*1 pi^o*} V li 4>li. liijl Sil J I^J J}1^ dk |*b u^jV'j ij^ <jf d* i>t^ }cr ¥ & 4 \$i 4P'f !\$"y £~ fj?j £ yu ^JL i5S Jal jfif j t>j 4>Uiil i^yjj JI Ijjjj G"" jv>li '££ Va J—J' 0? 4>^' !A\$ jv ^ ^iw fj (4^ j*^ jy« ..j « <c VI 52 i ^j&j! ^*rf . f. ,•! */• V// l '« (Jill VI tlft+i J^i ^ i <-'4,, / i -;Jf 433. Do they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is Able to give

life to the dead? Yes, He surely is Able to do all things> 434 . And on the Day when those who disbelieve will be exposed to the Fire (it will be said to them): "Is this not the truth?" They will say: "Yes, by our Lord!" He will say: "Then taste the torment, because you used to disbelieve!"} 435. Therefore be patient as did those of determination among the Messengers and be in no hurryfor them. On the Day when they will see what they are promised, it will be as though they had not remained (in the world) except an hour in a day. (This is) a clear Message. But will any be destroyed except the defiantly rebellious people?}

82 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iHe will say: "Then taste the torment, because you used to disbelieve!") Commanding the Prophet jg to persevere Allah then commands His Messenger jjjg to observe patience with those who rejected him among his people. He says, ft Ji j}-» j+'fy ^Therefore be patient as did those of determination among the Messengers meaning, as they were patient with their people's rejection of them. "Those of determination" among the Messengers are Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa, Isa and the last of all of the Prophets, Muhammad 5&. Allah has specifically mentioned their names in two Ayat: Surat Al-Ahzab (33:7) and Surat Ash-Shura (42:13). iand be in no hurry for them> which means, 'do not rush the punishment for them.' This is similar to Allah's saying: >4-*J iAnd leave Me alone to deal with the rejectors, those who are in possession ofgood things of life. And give them respite for a little while.} (73:11) ft* UgZ iSo allow timefor the disbelievers, and leave tliem for a while. (86:17) Then Allah says: if>Q <ji f jZj. £ c>Xe iOn the Day when they will see that which they are promised, it will be as though they had not remained (in the world) except an hour in a day Which is similar to Allah's saying, i N) ££) j iOti the Day they see it (the Hour), it will be as though they

Surah 46 AM, 33-35) (Part-26. 83 had not remained (in the world) except for a day's afternoon or its morning (79:46) and as He says, 4'0. 0« fcc. irjsJJ? iAnd on the Day when He shall gather them together, (it will be) as if they had not stayed but an hour of a day. They will recognize each other.>(10:45) Then Allah says. 4A clear message meaning, this Qur'an provides a clear concept. fjsi' VI iiji 4But will any be destroyed except tlie defiantly rebellious people Which means that Allah does not destroy anyone except those who choose the way of destruction. It is part of Allah's justice that He does not punish anyone except those who deserve the punishment - and Allah knows best. This concludes the explanation of Surat Al-Ahqaf. And all praise and blessings are due to Allah. Both success and protection from faults are by His help.

Surah 47: Muhammad

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Opening

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Opening denies them any rewards or blessings for them. This is similar to His saying, *And We will approach what they have done of deeds and make them as dispersed dust.* (25:23) Allah then says, *And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, Which means that their hearts and souls have believed, and their limbs and their hidden and apparent acts have complied with Allah's Law. And believe in that which has been sent down to Muhammad* Adding this statement to the previous one is a method of adding a specific meaning to a general one. This provides proof that after Muhammad's advent, believing in him is a required condition for the true faith. Allah then says, *For it is the truth from their Lord.* which is a beautifully placed parenthetical clause. Thus, Allah says, *He expiates from them their sins and amends their Bal.* Ibn 'Abbas, said, "This means their matter." Mujahid said, "This means their affair." Qatadah and Ibn Zayd both said, "Their condition." And all of these are similar in meaning. It has been mentioned (from the Prophet in the Hadith of the responding to one who sneezes, "May Allah guide you and rectify your (Bal) affairs. Then Allah says, *m Tuhfat Al-Ahwardhi 8 : 11 .*

Sip jir 51 si </ .i-f.'ltf • -K <f - ,{>..if .*,?- ^uiAX^SI^i0^jjSjfc 477ujf* is because those who disbelieve follow falsehood, meaning, 'We only invalidate the deeds of the disbelievers and overlook the sins of the righteous, and amend their affairs, because those who disbelieve follow falsehood.' Meaning, they choose falsehood over the truth. *o* 3* !# £>: il \$> Jjlllj iii ^i/ai J&&' J»JU* iwhile those who believe follow the truth from their Lord. Thus does Allah set forth for the people their parables. Thus He makes the consequence of their actions clear to them, and He shows them where they will end in their next life - and Allah knows best. *&- SUI K\) JIM & lib jlyi' Ijjli li[-£r- v> SJ' >!j) tijj^ j 1>U 0<l[> yjMU SJtl* (ifj* JvO^V ill' ilii jij idti l*>yl tffa ^ ppsP tMs <5> ^ U\$J0&®4\$ j&S 45 !£* Ut 4#^J4 iit &1 Z !>^ 4S 44. So, 10/ien you meet those who disbelieve (in battle), smite (their) necks until you have fully defeated them, then tighten their bonds. Thereafter (is the time) either for generosity or

ransom, until the war lays down its burden. Thus, and had Allah so willed, He could have taken vengeance against them; - but (He lets you struggle) so as to test with one another. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost.) 45. He will guide them and amend their condition .) 46. And admit them to Paradise, which He has made known to them.) 47. O you who believe! If you support (in the cause of) Allah, He will support you, and make your foothold firm.) 48. But as for those who disbelieve, misery awaits them, and (Allah) will make their deeds vain.) 49. That is because they hate that which Allah has sent down; so He has made their deeds fruitless.) The Command to strike the Enemies' Necks, tighten Their Bonds, and then free Them either by an Act of

Grace or for a Ransom Guiding the believers to what they should employ in their fights against the idolators, Allah says, 'So, when you meet those who disbelieve (in battle), smite their necks) which means, "when you fight against them, cut them down totally with your swords.' 4 > 4until you have fully defeated them,) meaning, "you have killed and utterly destroyed them.' 456ji' ^x^ 4tighten their bonds.) This is referring to the prisoners of war whom you have captured. Later on, after the war ends and the conflict has ceased, you have a choice in regard to the captives: You may either act graciously toward them by setting them free without charge, or free them for a ransom that you require from them.' It appears that this Ayah was revealed after the battle of

group) will fight against them, and Allah will bestow on them (war spoils) from them (the enemies) - until Allah's command comes to pass tohile they are in that state. Verily, the center of the believers abode is Ash-Sham. And goodness is tied around the horses'foreheads till the Day ofResurrection.^ An-Nasal also recorded this narration.12 ' Allah then says, 'J28 \$ SZ% 4Thus, and had Allah so willed, He could have taken vengeance against them;} which means that had He so willed, He could have taken immediate vengeance against the disbelievers with a chastisement or exemplary punishment directly from Him. ibut (He lets you struggle) so as to test with one another.} meaning, He has ordered Jihad and fighting against the enemies in order to tiy you and test your affairs. Allah also expresses His wisdom by the legislation of Jihad in the following two Surahs, Al 'Imran and At-Tawbah, in which He says, iOr did you think that you would enter the Paradise before Allah had made evident those ofyou whofight in His cause and made evident those who are steadfast?} (3:142) -f'A J ill 'J ffrfy iitj J-& iit . > y ' 4Fight them ; Allah will then punish them by your hands, disgrace them, grant you victory over them, satisfy the breasts of a believing people, and remove the fury of their (the believers') hearts. Allah turns in forgiveness to whom He wills; Allah is Knowing and Wise.} (9:14-15) Ahmad 4:104. An-Nasa! 6 :214 , and in Al-Kubra 5:218.

Merit ofthe Martyrs Since it is customary during wars that many of the believers die, Allah says: \$But those who are killed in the way ofAllah, He will never let their deeds be lost.} which means that He would not let their good deeds go to waste, but would rather multiply and increase them. Some of them will continue being rewarded for their good deeds for the entire length of their stay in Al-Barzakh.^ This has been mentioned in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad in his Musnad on the authority of Kathir bin Murrah, who reported from Qays Al-JudhamI, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger jg said, ! 4^0 fjA JIIP Ow* B Ifi'j < Ija jibj If Ejji3 if, oiLy.1 tjiiii «As the first drop ofhis blood gushes forth, a martyr is granted six merits : all of his sins are forgiven, he is shown his place in Paradise, he is married to wide-eyed Huris, he is secured from the greatfear (on Judgement Day) and the torment of the grave, and he is adorned with the adornments ofIman . Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith}2 ^ Abu Ad-Darda', may Allah be pleased with him, reported that Allah's Messenger jg said, «A martyr is allowed to intercede for seventy members of his householdJ This was recorded by Abu Dawud, 131 and there are numerous other Hadvths mentioning the merits of the martyrs. As for Allah's saying, (1 * The intermediate state between this life and the Hereafter. 121 Ahmad 4 :200 Abu Dawud no. 2522.

Surah 47, Muhammad (4-9) (Part-26) 92 irr-iZ-t 4He will guide them} meaning, He will guide them to Jarmah. This is similar to Allah's saying, >) rifi,i (*tj >fAr. i£>' ilindeed, those who have believed and

done righteous good deeds, their Lord will guide them because of their Faith : beneath them rivers willflow in the Gardens ofPleasure.} (10:9) Allah says, 4(& Q£} iand amend their condition.} meaning, their situation and affairs. 4And (He will) admit them to Paradise, which He has made known to them.} It means that He has acquainted them with Paradise and guided them to it. Mujahid said: “The people of Paradise will be guided to their houses and dwellings and whatever sections Allah has ordained for them in it. They will not make mistakes in this, nor will they ask anyone for directions to their dwellings - as if they had dwelt in it from the time they were first created.” Al-Bukhari recorded from Aba Said Al-Khudii, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah’s Messenger said, isV^j idlii o-jis’ «dliij b\s jjiL ;& ioif &Jij *)& jjtef U t& *After the believers securely pass the Fire (on the Day of Judgement), they will be held back upon a bridge between Paradise and the Fire. There, they will have any acts of injustice that they committed against one another in the life of 111 At-Tabari 22:160.

this world rectified. After they are completely purified and cleansed (from injustice), they will be admitted into Paradise. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, each one of them will find his way to his dwelling in Paradise better than he found his way to his dwelling in the worldly life.»in Support Allah’s Cause, He will then supportYou Allah then says: iO you who believe! If you support (the cause of) Allah, He will support you and make yourfootholdfirm. This is similar to His saying, iYCi* *& iln indeed, Allah will surely support those who support Him (His cause).} (22:40) That is because the reward is comparable to the type of deed that is performed. Thus, Allah says here. • V {and make yourfootholdfirm.} Allah then says, 4But asfor those who disbelieve - misery awaits them} This misery is the opposite of making firm the footholds of the believerswho support the cause ofAllah and His Messenger It has been confirmed in a Hadlth that Allah’s Messenger jg said, lil} lAdJxiJl xS 0 xJ- cjCln x* ’^4 *Jj&\ Sii vilui ^Misery awaits the servant of the Dinar; misery awaits the servant of the Dirham; misery awaits the servant of velvet. Misery awaits him, and degeneracy; and if he is vricked by a thorn, may he notfind anyone to pull itfor him .»|2’ ^ Al-Bukhari no . 6535. FathAl-Bari6 :95 and Ibn Majah 2 :1386

93Surah 47. Muhammad (10-13) (Part-26) This means may Allah not cure him. Then Allah says, iand (Allah) will make their deeds vain .) meaning, He will nullify them and make them fruitless. Thus, Allah says, iThat is because they hate that which Allalt has sent dmvn ;) which means that they did not want or like what Allah revealed. iso He made their deeds fruitless .) rpk j-pj ir. Jjf ii* SZ j ji\} Jr* sit 4 jp v 4^35 3; iii jp ii ii^ ^jigj J^i: Gf j£L- !}>r 3;i>j IvVi iff sf cffi gUJ ££ * a* jy A 46 iffa^ jog j&fi <10. Haw they not traveled through the earth and seen what happened in the end to those before them? Allah destroyed them completely, and a similar (awaits) the disbelievers .) 111 . That is because Allah is the Protector of those who believe, whereas the disbelievers have no protector.) 112. Certainly Allah will admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds, into Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise); while those who disbelieve enjoy their life and eat as cattle eat; but the Fire will be their abode.) 113. And how many a town mightier than your town that has driven you out We have destroyed, with none to help them!) Admonition and Fire for the Disbelievers; Paradise for ThoseWho have Taqwa. Allah says, iHave they not traveled) meaning, those who associate

partners with Allah and deny His Messenger jg. 4through the land and seen what happened in the end to those before them? Allah destroyed them completely,} which means that Allah punished them because

of their denial and disbelief, and saved the believers from among them. That is why He says, and a similar (end awaits) the disbelievers.} Then Allah says, & h & & o\ \$>} iThat is because Allah is the Protector of all those who believe, whereas the disbelievers have no protector.} After the battle of Uhud, Aba Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb, the commander of the idolators at that time, inquired about the Prophet sgi, Aba Bakr, and TJmar, may Allah be pleased with them. When he heard no response, he announced: "Verily, those three have died!" TJmar then responded to him: "You lie, O enemy of Allah! Allah has indeed saved those who will displease you. Indeed, those whom you mentioned are all alive!" Aba Sufyan then said: "Well, today makes up for (the defeat on) the day of Badr, and the war has its ups and downs. And indeed, you are going to find mutilation (in the bodies of your dead) that I did not command, nor did I prohibit." Then he turned around chanting: "Glory to Hubal (their greatest idol), Glory to Hubal." Allah's Messenger jg said: «Aren't you going to respond to him? The Companions said: "What should we say, O Messenger of Allah?" He jg said: •J>-fj jJUf iiii : b •Say; "Allah is Most High and Most Glorious." Then Aba Sufyan said: "We have Al-TJzza (their second idol),

and you have no Vzza. (honor)." Allah's Messenger gj| said: 'j'U "Aren't you all going to respond to him?*" They said: "What should we say, O Messenger of Allah?" He said: 'Say: "Allah is our Protector, and you have no protector. Allah then says, iVerily, Allah will admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds into Gardens through which riversflow meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. IT sjfc iWhereas those who disbelieve enjoy their life and eat as cattle eat> Which means that the disbelievers enjoy their worldly life and eat in it like animals, munching and gnawing (with greed). They have no concern other than that. Thus, it has been confirmed in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jjg said, "jUif jt jst ^ jsl; 'A believer eats with one intestine, and a disbeliever eats with seven intestines.»|2 ' Then Allah says, ip jp ibut the Fire will be their abode meaning, on the Day of their Reckoning. Allah then says, i<±^ ^it jk j. iAnd how many a town mightier than your town that has driven you oufy meaning, Makkah. 111 Fath Al-Bari 6:188. 121 Fath Al-Bari9:446.

4We /mye destroyed, with none to help them!} This is a great threat and severe warning to the people of Makkah because they rejected Allah's Messenger who was the chief of the Messengers and the last of the Prophets. If Allah had destroyed the previous nations because of their denial of their Messengers, what then would those (people of Makkah) expect that Allah would do to them in the worldly life and the Hereafter? And if the torment were to be lifted off some of them in this life by the blessing of the presence of the Messenger, the Prophet of Mercy, the torment will be stored for them in their next life, as Allah says, iTheir torment will be doubled! They could not bear to hear (the preaching), and they used not to see (the truth).} (11:20) Concerning Allah's saying, itlum Your town that has driven you out This means, 'its people who have driven you (Muhammad ag) out from amongst them (the people of Makkah).' Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that when Allah's Messenger left Makkah (at the time of Hijrah - migration), and he reached the cave and hid inside it, he looked back toward Makkah and said, i Sf v'ijj 4)1 is\ olij t 4)i ji jii aYou are the most beloved to Allah among Allah's lands, and you are also the most beloved to me among Allah's lands. Were it not that the idolators have driven me out from you, 1 would never have left you . Ibn 'Abbas then said, "The worst of enemies is he who transgresses against Allah in His own sacred place, who kills a person who is not trying to kill him, or who kills because of Jdhiliyyah vengeance. Allah then revealed to His Prophet jg,

iz&m o'a ** } sS * } S S s "i*'S <£j£ ^\y*?D\y***^ ^<3*^*-k^ 4C?J \$>i •*?>\$ jj jy JLi.1 Ajy jj |>U
>ib>r/j J^j' lil^i <s^^ iAnd how many a town mightier than your town that has driven you out have We
destroyed, with none to help them!}''* 11 zft <£ oi *i . & l& ft} \->M' y'' >-> >t T \y*r>j' 4.Q+' *->-» /0
up ^ ft & J2 if/*P */* ft PciP ft Z&S jx1» ^4^5 j*- liP. oi ^ ^ j? /^ l*rj j; v^~j v^' tLf it I^j ft 4 !*£ 4 ,, ^ ^
tij) 414. Gm then he, who stands on clear evidencefrom his Lord, be like those for whom their evil
deeds are beautified for them, while theyfollow their own lusts?} il5. The description ofParadise which
is promised to those zwho have Taqwd, (is that) in it are rivers ofwater that are not Asin, rivers of milk
the taste of which never changes, rivers of wine delicious to those who drink it, and rivers of refined
honey; and therein for them are all kinds of fruits, and forgiveness from their Lord. Can this be likened
to those wlv abide eternally in the Fire and are given to drink boiling water that severs their
intestines?} At-Tabari 22 :165

Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Al-Hasan, and Qatadah all said, "It does not change." *
Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak, and 'Ata' Al-Khurasani all said, "It is not foul- smelling." The Arabs say Asin if
its (water) scent changes.*2 '}& j^j} 4rivers of milk, the taste ofwhich never changes,\$ which means
that the milk is of utmost whiteness, sweetness, and richness. It has been mentioned in a Hadith
attributed to the Prophet jg "Their milk did not come out of the udders of cattle." i^rA }% f~ it 'J&}
drivers ofwine delightfiil to those who drink it,} hich means that the wine does not have a bad taste or
foul smell like that of the worldly life. Rather, it is good in its appearance, taste, smell, and effect, as
Allah says, p # iit (the wine) has no bad effects, nor does it cause intoxication .} (37:47) and, 1} iFrom
which (the wine) they will have no headache, nor will they be intoxicated.} (56:19) i&i} iwhite,
delicious to the drinkers.}(37-A6) It has been mentioned in a Hadith attributed to the Prophet 3g, "Their
wine was not pressed under men's feet." iand rivers of refined honey;} which means that the honey is of
utmost purity and pleasant color, taste, and smell. It has been mentioned in a Hadith attributed to the
Prophet jg, "Their honey did not come out of I 1 At-Tabari 22:166. * At-Jaban 22:167.

the bellies of bees." Imam Ahmad recorded from Hakim bin Mu'awiyah who narrated from his father
that Allah's Messenger jgg said, pi ysi\ 'jkjj jUJi jUd' cfi " Verily , there is in Paradise a lake of milk, a
lake of water, a lake of honey, and a lake of wine. The rivers then gush out of them . At-Tirmidhi
reported this narration in his section of the Description of Paradise, and he said, "Hasan Sahlh . In the
Sahih, it is recorded that Allah's Messenger jg said, Oj iriji a_jjtz.ll <&l jjLz lil ji'jZ *ijij jl+li > "When
you ask Allah, ask Him for Al-Firdaws, because it is the central and highest part of the Paradise, and
from it gush the rivers of the Paradise and above it is the Throne of the Most Merciful . |4) Allah says,
'\$» ft pii 4 . . .and thereinfor them are all kinds offruits, . . .} This similar to His saying, iThey will call
in it for every kind of fruit in peace and security.} (44:55) And His saying, AtffoCZ, \$ o; iln them will
be every kind offruits in pairs.} (55:52) Allah says This narration and the meaning of the one before it
were recorded by Ibn Al-Mundhir as a saying of Said bin Jubayr according to Ad- DurrAl-Manthur
6:25. Ahmad 5:5. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :287 141 Fath Al-Bari 6: 14.

r(*£j j; */i**jy i...andforgivenessfrom their Lord.} meaning, in addition to all of the above. Allah says,
4Can this be likened to those who abide eternally in the Fire^ meaning, 'can those that We have
described their position in the Paradise be like those who will abide eternally in the Fire?' They are not
equal, and nor are those who will be in the high ranks (in the Paradise) and those who will be in the

lowest depths (Hell). and are given to drink boiling water> meaning, extremely hot; so hot that it is unbearable. that severs their intestines meaning, that will cut their insides - both bowels and intestines. We seek refuge in Allah from that. jUljt lii'. 'iU iU' \jj\ affil ijli li) jj>- JtSl & ^6^ ZX* & *6W <\$>® 545 'rr\$£&£\$M § p.& JS Ssifif^ jUl; jcglib 5Ui) lit 416. And among them are some who listen to you till when they go out from you, they say to those who have received knowledge: "What is it that he has said just now? "Such are men whose hearts Allah has sealed because they followed their lusts.} 417. And as for those who accept guidance. He increases them in guidance and bestows on them their Taqwa.} 418. Do they then await except that the Hour should come upon them suddenly? But already there have come (some of) its portents; and when it (actually) is on them, how can they benefit then by their reminder?}

203Surah 47. Muhammad (16-19) (Part-26) }Do they then await except that the Hour should come upon them suddenly?} meaning, while they are unaware of it. iBut already there have come (some of) its portents;} meaning, the signs of its approach. This is similar to Allah's saying, // ^ i v ^ # / # jo / / / v iThis is a wamer of the ivamers of old. The approaching Day has drawn near.} (53:56-57) And His saying, **til' <ins*fy 477ie Hour has drawn near, and the moon has split.} (54:1) And His saying, :£»!\$ iThe command of Allah is coming, so do not be impatient for it.} (16:1) And His saying, 4rr - < <77k? people's Day ofReckoning has approached while they turn aivay in heedlessness .} (21:1) Thus, the Messenger's advent is one of the signs of the Hour, because he is the Finality of the Messengers. With him, Allah has completed the religion and established the evidence against all people in a way that was never done by a previous Prophet. Allah's Messenger jg has most clearly informed about the signs and indications of the Hour, as we have discussed elsewhere. Al-Bukhari recorded from Sahl bin Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, that he saw Allah's Messenger jg bring his index and middle fingers together while he said,

205Surah 47. Muhammad (16-19) (Part-26) myself. O Allah, forgive for me my joking, my seriousness, my unintended error, and my deliberate (mistakes) - and I have done ofall that It is also reported in the SahOi that he jg used to say at the end of the prayer, ii[v ^ 4j «0 Allah, forgive for me what I have previously done, what I may commit in future, what I have committed secretly, what I have committed openly, what I have done excessively, and all sins that You know better than me. You are my Cod. There is no (true) Cod except You.®'21 It is also recorded in the Sahth that he sg used to say, y 3^' y ^ 2*' yV y\ yy "O people! Repent to your Lord! Verily, I ask Allah for forgiveness and repent to Him more than seventy times every day Allah then says, iAnd Allah knows well your moving about, and your place of rest means, He knows how you behave during the day, and where you settle at night. This is similar to His saying, ilt is He Who takes your souls by night and knows all that you do by day.^ (6:60) And He says, -j icA—v;7/-> 111 Fath Al-Bari II :200. 121 Path Al-Bari 13:473. 131 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :104

-,/feAAB paiurq noAji, jo peajsuj ' .iCjuoiptB uaAiS ajaM noA Jf, :3unreai aqj }sa32ns UBqejL-iv Suipnput sjo}Bjuaumioo ouiog | t j 4tdti{supifo say JttoR J303S puv 'tgjvd uo uotfdujoo pvauds [^fwniv pstunf no!t /t 'sdvqjsd ttoR pinom 05 'Zff i'uuiif jo/JSffsq uosq 3(itn{ pptoof ft 'ift/gy of 3tu; ussq pvq /hip ft ustp 'psajossj si i3)fvm sip U3t{tn puy • spjooi pooS puv soustpsqQ • i uidip jo/usffsq svm ft fttg t/jvopfo uvsfjo/futv/ o; ftoqv si 01/m 3uo/o yoof 3tg ifftai noR fv Bupjooj (RsuoodRq /o) ssvsstp si sfjvsij ssotftn ut dsotp 335 uvo noR 'Suififit/ 8utuoifU3iu uaiop fuss st tivjus satssop v fvtpt

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Suiaout ou st Jti{fV)[uqi Jis/v± f\$5rsrr^Vl'^rr'^irrr^crh^ifr'r'Cifv^' 'A.- ir r\$?ir>P0 ' ft//• ^ <5^/' x ^ a' «
nv v *h' ZfVifp:P\ a^rr-fr? ajai/^ ^ nSigEgiff^i v» c

423 . Such are the ones whom Allah has cursed, so that He has made them deaf and blinded their vision.} The Situation of the True Believer and the Sick-Hearted when the Command for Jihad was revealed Allah mentions that the believers were hoping that Jihad would be legislated. But when Allah ordained it, many of the people turned back, as Allah says, Pj& A Si Ji >' \$¥ m 'X^ Ijlij Si\ j\ \$ jU s;*& jA cA e** yt} 2JI iHave you not seen those who were told : "Restrain your hands (from fighting), establish the Salah, and give Zakah." But then when fighting was ordained for them, you find a party of them fearing the people as they fear Allah or more. They said: "Our Lord! Why have You decreed fighting upon us? If only You have postponed us for a short period." Say: "The enjoyment of this world is little. The Hereafter is far better for him who had Ta'ajud of (Allah), and you will not be dealt with unjustly, even as much as a thin thread (inside a date's pit)."4(4:77) Similarly, Allah says here, 4 'jj— As XP !>.-.*» iThose who believe say: "Why is not a Surah sent down (for us)?"} means, a Surah containing an order to fight. Then He says, I^jli 4 C/J' cAj Aaf Y&i iBut now that a decisive Surah is sent down mentioning fighting, you can see those in whose hearts is disease looking at you with the look of one who is about to faint for fear of death.} meaning, due to their fear, terror, and cowardice concerning meeting the enemies. Allah then encourages them by saying, isf-d Jjjj ielL dj }But it was better for them, obedience and good words.}

Ike Tafstr Jbn Kathir which means that it would have been better for them to listen and obey in that present situation. W'& iWhen the matter (offighting) is resolved. which means when the situation becomes serious and the time of fighting truly arrives. iSt & they had been true to Allah, meaning, by making their intentions sincerely for Him. 4^ iit would have been better for them Allah then says, iSo would you perhaps, if you turned away meaning, from Jihad and you withdrew from it. J L>J— o' ispread corruption on earth, and sever your ties of kinship?} which means, would you then go back to your old practices of the time of ignorance: shedding blood and severing kinship ties? Allah then says, 'J&i \$P\$ 4Such are the ones whom Allah has cursed, so He has made them deaf and blinded their vision.} This involves a general prohibition of spreading corruption on earth, and a specific prohibition of severing the ties of kinship. In fact, Allah has commanded the people to establish righteousness on earth, as well as to join the ties of kinship by treating the relatives well in speech, actions, and spending wealth in charity. Many authentic and sound Hadiths have been reported through numerous routes of transmission from Allah's Messenger in this regard. Al-Bukhari recorded from Abd Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger sg said, 3*-j y oiii ilu jiiJi iii jisL» ^ ^ yr*3y Jlli XUJl IJla IcJU i : Jlii

«dU illii : J15 «After Allah completed creating the creation, the womb stood up and pulled at the lower garment of the Most Merciful. He said, 'Stop that!' It replied, 'My stand here is the stand of one seeking refuge in you from severance of ties.' Allah said, 'Would it not please you that I join whoever joins you

and sever whoever severs you?' It replied, 'Yes indeed!' He said, 'You are granted that!' Abu Hurayrah then added, "Read if you wish: 4 So would you perhaps, if you turned away, spread corruption on earth, and sever your ties of kinship?" Then Al-Bukhari recorded it with another wording which states that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, «4; 5» £ Sy 4 L > j l - a J 'f4 j > o! ^4 - * j - 4 ^ 4 'j * S *' o Read if you wish: 4 So would you perhaps, if you turned away, spread corruption on earth, and sever your ties of kinship?} Muslim also recorded it. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Bakrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: in «No sin deserves that Allah hasten its punishment in the worldly life, in addition to what He reserves in the Hereafter for those who commit it, more than injustice and severance of the ties of kinship This was also recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, and Ibn Majah. At-Tirmidhi said, "This Haclith is Sahfh." 121 Imam Ahmad recorded from Thawban, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, 111 Ahmad 5:38. I2 * Abu Dawud 5:208, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 : 213, Ibn Majah 2 : 1408.

i ***9 TJ J - ff * " * ^ ' 3 (j j * L H J l ' 3 " j l "Whoever likes for his life to be extended, and his provision increased, let him connect his ties of kinship . n * 1 ! Ahmad was alone in recording this narration, but it has a supporting narration in the Sahih. Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, * ^ 3 u Verily, the womb is attadied to the Throne. And connecting its ties does not mean dealing evenly (with the kinsfolk), but it rather means that if one's kinsfolk sever the ties, he connects them. W This Hadith was also recorded by Al-Bukhari. Ahmad also recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, ' j l i j L i L J j x J i £ » » » >] l \$ J f I f * J ~ ^ j ' J * The womb will be placed on the Day of Resurrection, curved like a spinning wheel, speaking with an eloquent fluent tongue, calling to severing whoever had severed it, and joining w l w e v e r h a d j o i n e d i f . » (3 1 Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger said, > i j i L i y j j * J * . "The mercifiil ones will be granted mercy from the Most Merciful. Have mercy on those on earth - the One above the heavens will then have mercy on you. And Ar-Rahim (the womb) is from Ar-Rahman, so whoever joins it, it joins him; [1 Ahmad 5:279, and similar with Al-Bukhari 5985. * Fath Al-Bari 10 : 437 , and Ahmad 2 : 163 {3} Ahmad 2:189.

m Surah 47. Muhammad (24-28) (Part-26) and whoever severs it, it severs liirn. n 111 Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi both recorded this Hadth and it has been reported with continuous chains of transmission. At-Trimidhi said, "Hasan Sahth."™ There are numerous other Hadiths in this regard. * 5 u \$ > & l i £ i l m M (* ^ J j * * ^ , » - * J o y t . ^ 5 ^ i U i i t j p V ? ^ 4 ^ t : i > / * i l l t * l y t - j i > 4 j t C j J l - i 4 f t p r 1 s . ^ 4 2 4 . M // they not then reflect upon the Qur'an, or are there locks upon their hearts?} 425. Verily, those who have turned back as disbelievers after guidance had become clear to them - Shaytan has enticed them and filled them with false hopes.} 426. That is because they said to those who hate what Allah has sent down: "We will obey you in part of the matter." And Allah knows their secrets.} 427. Then how (will it be) when the angels will take their souls at death, striking their faces and their backs?} 428. That is because they followed that which angered Allah and hated what earns His pleasure, so He rendered their deeds worthless.} The Command to reflect upon the Qur'an Commanding the people to reflect and ponder upon the Qur'an, and prohibiting them from turning away from it, Allah says, i Will they not then reflect upon the Qur'an, or are there locks upon their hearts?} 111 Ahmad 2:160. Abu Dawud 5 : 231 , and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 : 51

means, there indeed are locks upon some hearts, firmly closing them so that none of its meanings can reach them. Ibn Jarir recorded from Hisham bin 'Urwah, from his father, may Allah be pleased with him, that Allah's Messenger ﷺ once recited this Ayah, *Will they not then reflect upon the Qur'an, or are there locks upon their hearts?* and a young man from Yemen said, "Indeed, there are locks upon them - until Allah opens them totally or slightly." After that 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, always liked that young man, and kept that to himself until he became in charge, upon which he utilized him (as a consultant). Condemning Apostasy Allah then says, *Verily, those who have turned back meaning, they departed from the faith and returned to disbelief. And after guidance had become clear to them - Shaytan has enticed them meaning he adorned and beautified that (apostasy) for them. And filled them with false hopes. meaning, he tempted them, and deceived them. That is because they said to those who hate what Allah sent down: "We will obey you in part of the matter."* means, they plotted secretly with them and gave them evil advice - as is the common practice of the hypocrites who declare the opposite of what they conceal. Because of this, At-Tabari 22 : 180

113 Surah 47. Muhammad (24-28) (Part-26) Allah says, *And Allah knows their secrets.* whatever they hide and conceal, Allah is well-acquainted with it and He knows it. This is similar to His saying, *And Allah records all that they plot by night.* (4:81) Allah then says, *-V-I' -**** ' > . ' tf'-l'ff »&.0J 3Z>}* 4How (will it be) when the angels will take their souls at death, striking their faces and their backs? That is, how their situation will be when the angels come to take their lives, and their souls cling to their bodies, causing the angels to extract them by force, harshness, and beating. This is similar to Allah's saying, *And you could but see when the angels take away the lives of the disbelievers, striking their faces and their backs.* (8:50) And His saying, *And you could but see when the wrongdoers are in the agonies of death, while the angels extend their hands* (6:93). meaning, to beat them. 4\$? 'oft&Ji & 4(saying) : "Deliver your souls! This day you will be recompensed with the torment of degradation because of what you used to utter against Allah other than the truth, and because you used to arrogantly reject His signs." (6:93) Because of the above, Allah says, *fc/y^aj 'jiy==j Xa C^ii'j}*

^ XZbi& == j^ 4ii\j3yi\^3 ijyr \c? \$±fi\$&o[£syst\$]^ca j^Ui!^2j!^si0 4That is because they pursued what angered Allah and disliked what earns His pleasure, so He rendered their deeds worthless.} j-vji 4 CoS- fi} jii> aiSj J>iN lj>J !>*. IjUj 429. Or do f/iouse in whose hearts is a dis- ease, think that Allah will not expose their ill- wills?^ 430. Had We so willed, We could have shown them clearly to you, so that you would know them by their marks; but you will know them by the tone of their speech! And Allah knows (all) your deeds.} 431. And We will surely, try you until We know those who strive among you and the patient, and We will put to a test all your affairs.} - *. 'X 'Gr K* J • 3 J - a ^ j j j j j \$\$\$£3 Exposing the Hidden Secret of the Hypocrites Allah says, *Or do those in whose hearts is disease think that Allah would never expose their ill-wills?* meaning, do the hypocrites think that Allah will not expose

115 Surah 47. Muhammad (29-31) (Part-26) their affair to His believing servant? Yes indeed, He will expose their affair and manifest it so that those with insight will be able to understand it. In that regard, Allah revealed Surah Bard'ah (or At-Tau>bah), in which He clarified the hypocrites' scandals, and

pinpointed their practices that are indicative of their hypocrisy. Because of that, this Sūrah (Surah Bara'ah) is also called "The Exposer". Adgh&n is the plural of Dighn, which means what the souls harbor of envy and hatred toward Islam and its people who support it. Allah then says, 4Had We so willed, We could have shown them clearly to you, so that you would know them by their marks. Allah is telling His Messenger ag, "Had We willed, O Muhammad, We would have shown you the specific individuals who are hypocrites, so that you would plainly know them." However, Allah did not do that in regard to all of the hypocrites. He conceals His creation, lets their affairs run according to apparent purity, and leaves the inner secrets to the One Who is well aware of them. Allah then adds, /1 . mA*' »// \ 4Jyl' ^ r 4But you will know them by the tone of their speech!} which means, you will know them by their speech that reveals their intentions.' A person declares his association through the context and meaning of his words - as the Commander of the faithful 'Uthman bin 'Affan, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "Never would one conceal a secret but Allah will expose it by the look on his face and the uncontrolled words of his tongue." Allah then says, 4And We will surely try you} meaning, We will surely test you with commands and prohibitions.' tjixj |£»-^ iuntil We know those who strive among you and the patient,

and We will put to a test all your affairs.} There is absolutely no doubt that Allah's knowledge precedes the occurrence of all events. In this Ayah, "until We know" means "until We know of its occurrence." This is why Ibn 'Abbas said in regard to this and similar texts, "Except so that We may know, means, so that We may see." iir*" i) L* Ji J iytij 6 % 4#t 'it t£C 'S <U. it *»>' JCu 'frj \yC ^ «it I^T jjt\ tA Jj fiz itj Sjg/t 0j&4 £2j ££* £ 432. Verily, those ivho disbelieve, and hinderfrom the path of Allah, and oppose the Messenger, after the guidance lias been clearly shown to them, they will not harm Allah in the least, but He will make their deeds fruitless,} 433. O you who believe! Obey Allah, and obey the Messenger and invalidate not your deeds.} 434. Verily, those who disbelieved and obstructed others from the path of Allali and then died as disbelievers - never will Allah notforgive them.} 435. So do not lose heart and beg for peace while you are superior. Allah is with you and He will never deprive you of (the reward of) your deeds.} Nullifying the Disbelievers' Deeds and theCommand to chaseThem Allah then informs about those who disbelieve, obstruct others from the path of Allah, oppose the Messenger sg and contend with him, and revert from the faith after guidance has become clear to them. He indicates that those people can never harm Allah in the least, and rather they only harm themselves and become losers on the Day of Resurrection. He will nullify their deeds. Allah will not reward them even the weight of a mosquito (i.e., the smallest thing) for any good that they did before their apostasy, but would instead totally invalidate and destroy it. Their apostasy wipes away their good deeds entirely, just as the good deeds would normally wipe away the evil

deeds. Imam Ahmad Ibn Nasr Al-Marwazi reported in Kitab As-Salah (the Book of Prayer) that Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "The Prophet's Companions used to think that no sin would harm a person who says 'La ilaha illallah, ' just as no good deed would benefit a person who joins partners with Allah. So Allah revealed, % j£it ljXx, -it \S\} iObey Allah and obey the Messenger and do not invalidate your deeds.} This made them fear that some sins could nullify their deeds." 11 It has also been reported from Ibn TJmar, may Allah be pleased with him, that he said, "We, the Companions of Allah's Messenger used to think that good deeds would all be accepted, until Allah revealed, \$£% j#f \jS\jS iObey Allah and obey the Messenger and do not invalidate your deeds.} So we asked each other: What is it that can nullify

our deeds?' So we said, The major sins, great offenses that require admission into the Fire and immoral sins.' But then Allah revealed, *cdj'j ojj U jily Aj~i 3 ^ 0)^ i* Verily, Allah does not forgive joining partners ivith Hint in worship, but Heforgives except that to whom He wills.} (4 :48) After this was revealed, we ceased saying that. We thereafter continued to fear for those who committed great sins and immoral sins and to have hope for those who did not."*2 ' Then, Allah commands His believing servants to obey Him and His Messenger s£, which would result in their happiness in this worldly life and the Hereafter. He also prohibits them from apostasy, because that would result in the nullification of their deeds. Thus He says. As-Salah by Al-Marwazi 2 :645. '2 As-Salah by Al-Marwazi 2 :646.

%} 4and do not invalidate your deeds.} meaning, by apostasy. Thus, Allah says after this, -iflt jilv jit jUS"" ptj \}C y jii if- \jx*j 1\$ i\} i Verily, those who disbelieved and obstructed others from the path of Allah and then died as disbelievers - never will Allah forgive them.} This is similar to His saying, £ /M) •fj, jiS4 d Sltf 4^ i Verily, Allah does not forgive joining partners with Him in worship, but Heforgives except that to whom He wills.} (4:48) Allah then addresses His believing servants by saying, 4So do not lose heart} meaning, do not be weak concerning the enemies. m\\&j} iand begfor peace} meaning, compromise, peace, and ending the fighting between you and the disbelievers while you are in a position of power, both in great numbers and preparations. Thus, Allah says, 4So do not lose heart and beg for peace while you are superior.} meaning, in the condition ofyour superiority over your enemy. If, on the other hand, the disbelievers are considered more powerful and numerous than the Muslims, then the Imam (general commander) may decide to hold a treaty if he judges that it entails a benefit for the Muslims. This is like what Allah's Messenger did when the disbelievers obstructed him from entering Makkah and offered him treaty in which all fighting would stop between them for ten years. Consequently, he jg agreed to that. Allah then says:

4And Allah is with you} This contains the good news of victory and triumph over the enemies. i&a& 4and He will never deprive you of (the reward of) your deeds.} meaning, Allah will never invalidate your deeds, nullify them, or deprive you of them, but rather He will give you your rewards complete, without any reduction." And Allah knows best. If-iii' iafj jc Jii-i, il*r; i>*J J^rl o' <if «### *2& Cj>^ \$2^ 436. This worldly life is only amusement and diversion. And if you believe and have Tacjwa of Allah, He will grant you your rewards, and will not ask from you (to sacrifice all of) your possessions.} 437. If He would demand of you all of it and urge you, you would withhold. And He will expose your (secret) ill-wills.} 438. Here you are now invited to spend in Allah's cause; but among you are those who withlwd (stingily) . And whoever acts stingily is but stingy toward himself. For Allah is indeedfree of needs, while you are the needy. And ifyou turn away, He will replace you with other people; then they will not be like you.} Showing the Triviality of the Worldly Life and encouraging Spending Expressing the insignificance and worthlessness of the worldly life, Allah says, 4This worldly life is only amusement and diversion.} which means that such is its outcome, except for that which is done for the sake of Allah. Because of this, Allah says,

VJ iy^j irii <j!j>k 4And 1/ you believe and have Taqwa of Allah, He will grant you your rewards, and will not askfrom you (to sacrifice all of) your possessions . meaning, He is in no need of you, and asks you for nothing. He only ordained giving charity from your wealth so that you would help your needy brothers. The benefit of that would then come back to you, as well as the rewards. Allah then says, 4!£?

t&H oik ilfHe would demand ofyou all of it and urge you, you would withhold. meaning, ifHe pressures you much, you would become stingy. iAnd He will expose your (secret) ill-wills-k Qatadah said, “Allah knows that extracting wealth (i.e., money from people) brings about ill-wills.” * Indeed, Qatadah has said the truth, because money is dear to the people, and they do not spend it except in things that are dearer to them than it. Allah then says, o* Jrp 4 i >it£k iHere you are now invited to spend in Allah’s cause; but among you are those who withhold (stingily).} meaning, they refuse to spend. Allah continues, 4.A— Je. 3^45 «>jk iAnd whoever acts stingily is but stingy toward himself.} meaning, he only reduces his own rewards, and the bad outcome of that will come back to him. i&li SSSk iFor Allah is indeed Al-Ghani} Allah is in need of nothing else, whereas everything is ever in *** ‘Abdur-Razzaq 3 :224

121Surah 47. Muhammad (36-38) (Part-26 need of Him. Thus, Allah says, &3X Awhile you are the needy. meaning, specifically of Him. The description of Allah as Al- Ghani (in no need) is a necessary description of Allah; on the other hand, the description of the creation as Faqr (needy) is a necessary description for them that they cannot avoid. Allah then says, 4!ii|>~ iAnd if you turn away,) which means, if you turn away from obeying Him and adhering to His Laws. iHe will replace you with other people; then they will not be like you.) meaning, rather, they will be people who will listen to Him and obey His commands. This concludes the Tafsir of Surat Al-QitaL And Allah is worthy of all praise and gratitude.

Surah 48: Al-Fath

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Fath

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5406]

(Chapter - 48) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah The Merit of Surah Al-Fath Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘Abdullah bin Mughaifal, who said that Allah’s Messenger ﷺ recited Surah Al-Fath on the (day) of the conquest of Makkah, riding on his she-camel. He recited it in a vibrating and pleasant tone. Mu’awiyah (a subnarrator) added: “Were I not afraid that the people would crowd around me, I would surely try to imitate and produce his recitation.” Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this Hadith through Shu’bah. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. *Cj 0? fii £ ii' ' f. j/£*> iil \ U>> 41 .* Verily, We have given you a manifest victory. 42. That Allah may forgive you your sins of the past and the future, and complete His favor on you, and guide you on the straight path,} 43. And that Allah may help you with strong help.}

The Reason behind revealing SuratAl-Fath

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5406–5412]

This honorable Surah was revealed after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ returned from the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah, during the month of Dhul-Qa’dah, in the sixth year of Hijrah. This is when the idolators prevented him from reaching Al-Masjid Al-Haram to perform the Umrah he intended. They stopped the Prophet ﷺ from reaching Makkah at that time, but then were prone to peace negotiations. A peace treaty was conducted

stipulating that the Messenger ﷺ would return this year and then come back for Umrah the following year. The Messenger ﷺ agreed. However, some of the Companions disliked these terms, including Thmar bin Al-Khattab, as we will mention in detail, Allah willing, while explaining this Surah. After the Prophet ﷺ slaughtered his sacrificial animals in the area where he was stopped and headed back to Al-Madinah, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored revealed this Surah about what occurred between him and the idolators. Allah declared the Al-Hudaybiyyah peace treaty a manifest victory, because of the benefits peace would carry and the good results that did originate from it. ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud and other Companions said, “You consider the conquering of Makkah to be Al-Fath (the victory), while to us, Al-Fath is the treaty conducted at Al-Hudaybiyyah.” Jabir (bin ‘Abdullah) said, “We only considered Al-Fath to be the day of Hudaybiyyah!” 11 Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara’ (bin ‘Azib) said, “You consider Al-Fath to be the conquest of Makkah, which was indeed a victory. However, we consider Al-Fath to be the pledge of Ar-Ridwan on the Day of Al-Hudaybiyyah. Then, we were fourteen hundred with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Al-Hudaybiyyah had a well, whose water we consumed, not

leaving a drop of water in it. When the news of what happened reached the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, he came towards us and sat on the edge of the well. Then he asked to be brought a bucket of water and used it for ablution. He next rinsed his mouth, invoked Allah and poured that water into the well. Soon after, that well provided us, as well as our animals, with sufficient water, in whatever amount of water we wished.”*2’ Imam Ahmad recorded that Thumar bin al-Khattab said, “We were with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ on a trip, and I asked him about a matter three times, but he did not answer me. So I said to myself, ‘May your mother lose you, O son of al-Khattab! You were stubborn in repeating your question three times to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ; each time he did not respond to you.’ So I mounted my animal, my camel, and went ahead for fear that a part of the Qur’an might be revealed in At-Tabari 22 :201 ’2| FathAl-Bari 7 -.505.

124 Tafstr Ibn Kathir my case. Suddenly, I heard a caller calling, ‘O ‘Umar!’ So, I went to the Messenger ﷺ while fearing that part of the Qur’an was revealed about me. The Prophet said, J £3 : I** Uj CjJi ^ ^ Jy" • Cj iiUi J* fjjb U ill liS uLast m'g/it, a Surah was revealed to me that is dearer to me than this life and all that it contains: iVerily, We have given you a manifest victory. That Allah may forgive you your sins of the past and the future Al-Bukhari, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal collected this Hadith from several chains of narration through Malik, may Allah grant him His mercy.121 ‘Ali bin al-Madlani commented, “This is a good chain of narration consisting of the scholars of al-Madlani.” Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “This Ayah was revealed to the Prophet ﷺ that Allah may forgive you your sins of the past and the future,} on his return from al-Hudaybiyyah. The Prophet said, •^*jVi JU iL \$ \ z\ inJi 4U oJjif iai» ^Tonight, an Ayah, that is dearer to me than all that the earth carries, was revealed to me.» The Prophet recited the Ayah to them. They said, ‘Congratulations, O Allah’s Messenger! Allah the Exalted and Most Honored has stated what He will do with you. So what will He do with us?’ These Ayat were revealed to the Prophet ﷺ oi 5?Q} iThat He may admit the believing men and the believing women to Gardens under which rivers flow...}, until, 111 Ahmad 1 :31. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:675, Tuhfat al-Ahwadhi 9:167, An-Nasal in al-Kubra. 6 :46 1

i...a supreme success. ,in This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs,*2 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that al-Mughirah bin Shu‘bah said, “The Prophet ﷺ used to pray until both his feet were swollen. He was asked, “Has not Allah forgiven you all your sins of the past and of future?” He ﷺ said, jJj. lJlp «Should I not be a thankful servant?”*3 ' The two collectors of the Sahihs collected this Hadith, as well as, the rest of the Group, except Abu DawudJ41 Allah’s statement, 4ip£4 £2 <3 £3 iVerily, We have given you a manifest victory. means, clear and apparent victory. This Ayah is about the treaty at al-Hudaybiyyah, which resulted in great goodness, including people embracing Islam in large crowds and having the chance to meet each other openly. During that time, the believers preached to the idolaters and thus beneficial knowledge and faith spread all around. Allah’s statement, 4 Cij liLj (ja ^JUL C *1)1 viS] iThat Allah may forgive you your sins of the past and the future, contains one of the special virtues of the Messenger ﷺ, and no one else shares this honor with him. There is not an authentic Hadith that states that any person other than the Messenger ﷺ earned forgiveness for all of his sins of the past and future on account of performing good deeds. This, indeed, is a great honor for the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, who fulfilled the 111 Ahmad 3:197. FathAl-Bari 7:516, Muslim 3:1413. [31 Ahmad 4:55. |4 I Al-Bukhari no. 4836, Muslim no. 2819, At-Tirmidhi no. 412, An-Nasal 3:219 and Ibn Majah no. 1419.

227 Surah 48. Al-Fath (4-7) (Part-26) Allah will elevate your status and give you victory above your enemies. An authentic Hadith states, 'Y' yuu <il Slj y <u -x>-t ^p\y \Stj ',yU; iui -Uij VJ *No servant pardons but Allah grants him honor, and none humbles him- self for Allah except that Allah the exalted and sublime raises him (in rank). 'Umar bin Al-Khattab said, "You will never punish someone who disobeyed Allah with you better than obeying Allah the Exalted and Most Honored with him." jr oi\ BEmiM '-rf-ift > >> ' ' Z C- A4.) OM * -'i* f. '—=u a_j»*. -Jja Cjfhii jjli j4j jit11"! 1^1 Ijj'jjJ joji)' syS 4 Bjil y>^ 4*4 jvVf (ff *4jSj jjjj q; lit 56 ^Vtj JI CtXMJ . s , U.ljfe Ijyi AJjt XJ~ dllj (jKj - 1 ~- yJ ^4^ lit s— t>-lt i^jTj tjJI r'Qj jit d/oL^)' c^iiltj f ' jsf -[?5 t '•iif < ' > *- -'; -/ ' * .r-" o! *'{ *n' oKj ufjj'j V>>* — 1 *jr*f >X4>- -U-'j 44. He it is Who sent down As-Sakinah into the hearts of the believers, that they may grow more in faith along with their faith. And to Allah belong the armies of the heavens and the earth. Muslim 4:2001.

earth, and Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise. 45. That He may admit the believing men and the believing women to Gardens under which rivers flow to abide therein forever, and He may expiate from them their sins; and that is with Allah supreme success 46. And that He may punish the hypocrites men and women, and also the idolators men and women, who think evil thoughts about Allah, for them is a disgraceful torment. And the anger of Allah is upon them, and He has cursed them and prepared Hell for them and worst indeed is that destination 47. And to Allah belong the armies of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise. Allah sent down the Sakinah into the Hearts of the Believers Allah the Exalted said, 4^\$ & 4He it is Who sent down As-Sakinah}, meaning, tranquility. Qatadah commented, "Grace into the hearts of the believers", that is, the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, on

the Day of Al-Hudaybiyyah. The companions were they, who

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5412–5451]

accepted the call of Allah and His Messenger jg and obeyed the decisions of Allah and His Messenger jg. When their hearts felt content with acceptance and were at peace, Allah increased their faith, joining it to the faith they already had. Al-Bukhari, and other Imams, relied on this Ayah as proof that faith increases and decreases in the hearts. Allah the Exalted said next that had He willed, He would have inflicted defeat on the disbelievers, Allah says; 4 lyylil' ij~*r 4And to Allah belong the armies of the heavens and the earthy and had He willed to send only one angel to them, that angel would have brought destruction to all what they had. However, Allah the Exalted willed Jihad and fighting to be established for, and by, the believers for great wisdom, clear reasons and unequivocal evidences that He had in all this. This is why Allah the Great said next,

tl fy <i' ^J^i} }and Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise.} Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, JrR Jt <jfy**' iTftat He may admit the believing men and the believing women to Gardens under which rivers flow to abide therein forever,} We mentioned the Hadith that Anas narrated in which the Companions said, "Congratulations, O Allah's Messenger! This good news is for you, so what good news do we have?" Allah the Exalted sent down this Ayah, 4^ oyji *fr^i tff Jt \$That He may admit the believing men and the believing women to Gardens under which rivers flow to abide therein forever, meaning they will remain in Paradise forever. iand He may expiate from them their sins;} Allah will not

punish them for their errors and mistakes. Rather, He will forgive, absolve and pardon them and cover the errors, grant mercy and appreciate, and that is with Allah supreme success.} Allah the Exalted said in a similar Ayah, }And whoever is removed away from the Fire and admitted to Paradise, he indeed is successful.} (3:185) Allah said, fF i fit chilli) ij.'iy.Qvy jviiiili ^jXjij} iAnd that He may punish the hypocrites, men and women, 111 Fath At-Bari 7:516.

and also the idolators, men and women, who think evil thoughts about Allah,} who question the wisdom in Allah's decisions and think that the Messenger jg and his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, might be killed and exterminated. This is why Allah the Exalted said, •vjt* fr^-} ifor than is a disgraceful torment. And the anger of Allah is upon them, and He has cursed them} He has cast them away from His mercy, 4i\$-y* OlCj dj} iand prepared Hell for them - and worst indeed is that destination.} Allah the Exalted and Most Honored asserted His ability to take revenge from the enemies of Islam and all disbelievers and hypocrites, lif ut<j jfj'dj IjLi- jtf} iAnd to Allah belong the armies of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Ever All-Powerful, All-Wise.} [y^yi L iy s@ S if Uli 3joC iy^x 4 v ^ ii jiji s*J 32 4#- Verily, We have sent you as a witness, as a bearer of glad tidings, and as a Warner.} 49. hi order that you (O mankind) may believe in Allah and His Messenger and that you Tu'azzirih and Tuwaqqiruh, and Tusabbihih Bukrah and Asila.} 410. Verily, those who give pledge to you, they are giving pledge to Allah. The Hand of Allah is over their hands. Then whosoever breaks his pledge, breaks it only to his own harm; and whosoever fulfills what he has the covenants he makes with Allah, He will bestow on him a great reward.}

131 Surah 48. Al-Fath (8-10) (Part-26) Qualities of the Messenger of Allah \$5 Allah the Exalted says to His Prophet, Muhammad jfe, iVerily, We have sent you as a witness of the creation, ias a bearer of glad tidings> to the believers, 4and as a Warner to the disbelievers. We explained these meanings in the Tafstr of Surat Al-AhzabJ 11 Allah said, iln order that you may believe in Allah and His Messenger, and that you Tu'azzirih} or you honor him, according to 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas and several others, iand Tuwaqqiruh}, where Tawqir means, respect, honor and high regard, J y> > - V iand that you Tusabbihih}, glorify Allah's praises, iBukrah and Asilai, the early and late part of the day. The Pledge of Ar-Ridwan Allah the Exalted and Most Honored honors, regards and praises His Messenger by saying, C» JI'*.£ & 111 See volume seven, the Tafstr of Surat Al-Ahz&b (33 : 45 - 46) 121 At-Tabari 22:207.

132 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iVerily, those who give pledge to you, they are giving pledge to Allah.} Allah the Exalted and Most High said in another Ayah, -Iji £} iHe who obeys the Messenger, has indeed obeyed Allah.} (4:80) Allah said, next, jji «if iThe Hand of Allah is over their hands.} meaning, He is with them, hearing their statements and witnessing their stand, having full knowledge of them inwardly and outwardly. There- fore, Allah the Exalted was indeed taking the pledge from them through His Messenger jg, 4 ^ ^ 'Jj3 it %} £5 o ^ ^ % >££ if^ jyjt 'y, iijt jXfl i fA sfr, '{4+h * U'ltt 4Verily, Allah has purchased of the believers their lives and their properties for which theirs shall be the Paradise. They fight in Allah's cause, so they kill and are killed. It is a promise in truth, binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an. And who is truer to his covenant than Allah? Then rejoice in the bargain you have concluded. That is the supreme success.^(9:111) Allah said, be £1 * <“t la@ £, ijt £f} 4 ...and whosoever fulfills what the covenants he makes with Allah, He will bestow on him a great

reward.} a generous reward. The pledge mentioned here is the pledge of Ar-Ridwan which was pledged under a tree, a Samurah, in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah. The number of the Companions who gave their pledge to Allah's Messenger jg at that time was either 1,300, 1,400 or 1,500. However, 1,400 is the better choice.

Hadiths about the Pledge at Al-Hudaybiyyah Al-Bukhari recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, "We numbered one thousand and four hundred on the day of Hudaybiyyah."* 1 Muslim also collected this Hadith. 2' The Two Sahihs recorded that Jabir said; "We numbered one thousand and four hundred at that time. The Messenger jg placed his hand in the water and it started gushing forth from between his fingers until everyone had quenched their thirst."*31 This is a short form of the story. Another narration of it mentioned that the Companions became thirsty on the day of Al-Hudaybiyyah and the Messenger of Allah jg gave them an arrow from his quiver. They took the arrow, placed it in the well of Al-Hudaybiyyah and the water gushed out until they all satisfied their thirst. Jabir was asked how many of them there were on that day and he said, "We were one thousand and four hundred. And had we been a hundred thousand, that water would still have been sufficient to satisfy us all."*4 * In another narration collected in the Two Sahihs, Jabir bin 'Abdullah said that they were one thousand and five hundred at the time.*5 Al-Bukhari recorded that Said bin Al-Musayyib was asked by Qatadah, "How many were present for the pledge of Ar- Ridwan?" Said said, "One thousand and five hundred." Qatadah posed, "Jabir bin 'Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with them both, said that they were one thousand and four hundred." Said said, "He forgot. He told me that they were one thousand and five hundred."*6 * However, Al-Bayhaqi commented, "This narration testifies that Jabir used to state that they were one thousand and five hundred, but later on remembered the true number and said that they were one thousand and four hundred."*7 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :45 1 * Muslim 3 :1484 * Fath Al-Bari 7 :505 and Muslim 3 :1484 ' Fath Al-Bari 7:504. *s * Fath Al-Bari7 :507 and Muslim 3 : 1484 ' FathAl-Bari7:507. 171 Dala'ilAn-Nubuwwah 4 :97

134 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Reason behind conducting the Pledge of Ar-Ridwan Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said in his book on Sirah: "The Messenger of Allah sg beckoned Umar bin Al-Khattab in order to send him to Makkah, so that he could inform the chiefs of Quraysh of the Prophet's intent (to perform Vmrah at Makkah). Umar said, 'O Allah's Messenger! I fear the Quraysh for my being. There are no longer any chiefs from the tribe of Bani 'Adi bin Ka*b remaining in Makkah who would protect me, in addition, the Quraysh know my enmity and harshness against them. However, I could tell you about a man who is mightier than I in Makkah: Uthman bin 'Affan. We should send him to Abu Sufyan and the chiefs of the Quraysh informing them that you did not come to fight them, but to. visit this House and to honor its holiness.' Uthman left to Makkah. He met Aban bin Said bin Al-'As upon entering Makkah or just before that. As a result, Aban took Uthman with him and extended his protection to him so he could deliver the message of Allah's Messenger jg. Uthman indeed went to Abu Sufyan and the chiefs of Quraysh and imparted the Prophet's message that he was sent with. When Uthman finished delivering the Prophet's message to them they said to him, If you wish, you can perform Tawaf around the House.' Uthman replied, I would not do that before the Messenger of Allah gets the chance to perform Tawaf around it.' So the Quraysh kept Uthman waiting in Makkah. However, the Messenger of Allah jg and the Muslims were told that Uthman had been killed." Ibn Ishaq continued, "I was told by 'Abdullah bin Abu Bakr that when news of Uthman's death was conveyed to him, the Messenger

of Allah said, ³?^ & •kVe will not leave until we fight the people .s”¹¹ Ibn Ishaq continued, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ called the Muslims to give a pledge of allegiance, resulting in the pledge of Ar-Ridwan being conducted under the tree. Later, people used to say that the Messenger of Allah took the pledge from them to die. However, Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, The ^ Ibn Hisham 3 :329-330. This part of the narration is not authentic but its general meaning is found in the upcoming references

Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not ask us to give a pledge to die (or be victorious), but that we would not run away (from battle).’ The Muslims gave their pledge and none among them held back from giving it, except Al-Jadd bin Qays from the tribe of Bani Salamah. Jabir used to say afterwards, ‘By Allah, it is as if I am looking at him now next to the shoulder of his camel taking refuge behind it, so that the people did not see him.’ Soon afterwards, news came to the Messenger of Allah that the story of Tjthman’s death was not true.” Al-Bukhari recorded that Nafi’ said, “People said that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar embraced Islam before ‘Umar, but this is not true. What happened is that on the Day of Hdaybiyyah, ‘Umar sent ‘Abdullah to bring his horse that he kept with a man from Al-Ansar, so he could use it to fight. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was then taking the pledge from the Muslims under the tree while ‘Umar was unaware. So, ‘Abdullah conducted his pledge and fetched the horse and brought it to ‘Umar, who was wearing his armor in preparation for battle. ‘Abdullah told Umar that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was accepting the pledge under the tree. ‘Umar proceeded with ‘Abdullah and gave his pledge to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ- This is why some people thought that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar embraced Islam before ‘Umar, may Allah be pleased with them both.” Al-Bukhari also recorded Ibn ‘Umar saying that, the people who were with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ scattered under the shade of trees. Suddenly, the people gathered around the Prophet ﷺ and ‘Umar said, “O ‘Abdullah! Investigate why the people are gathering around Allah’s Messenger.” Ibn ‘Umar found the people giving their pledge. He gave his pledge, then went back and told ‘Umar, who also went and gave his pledge. In a Hadith collected by Muslim, 151 Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “On the day of Al-Hdaybiyyah, we were one thousand and four hundred. We gave the pledge of allegiance to the Prophet while ‘Umar was holding the Prophet’s hand ¹¹¹ See the references for Muslim that follow. ¹²¹ Ibn Hisham 3 :329-330. ¹³¹ Fath Al-Bari 7 :52 1 ¹⁴¹ Path Al-Bari 7:521. ¹⁵¹ Muslim 3 :1483

¹³⁶ Tafsir Ibtt Kathir under the tree, which was a Samurah (a kind of thorny tree). We gave the pledge to him not to run away (from battle). We did not give the pledge to die.” Muslim recorded that Ma’qil bin Yasar, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “On the day of the Tree, while the Prophet ﷺ was taking the pledge from the people, I was holding a branch of that tree away from his head. We were fourteen hundred. We did not give him our pledge to die, but gave the pledge not to run from battle.” However, Al-Bukhari recorded that Salamah bin Al-Akwa’, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I gave the pledge to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ under the tree.” Yazid asked him, “O Abu Maslamah, to what did you pledge at that time?” Salamah said, “To die!”² Al-Bukhari also collected a Hadith from Salamah bin Al-Akwa’ that he said, “I gave my pledge to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ on the day of Hdaybiyyah. I stood to the side and the Messenger ﷺ said, *Wh\j notgive thepledge, O Salamah?» and I said, *1 did.’He ﷺ said, “Come and give pledge». I went close to him and gave him my pledge.” Salamah was asked, “What was the pledge that you gave then, O Salamah?” Salamah said, “To die.”³ Muslim collected this Hadith * as well, while Al-Bukhari collected from ‘Abbad binTamlm that the pledge they gave was to die.*⁵ Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Salamah bin Al-Akwa’, may Allah be pleased

with him said, “We went to Al-Hudaybiyyah with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and we numbered fourteen hundred at that time. We reached the well and found around fifty sheep drinking from it, but its water was barely sufficient for them. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ sat on its rim, invoked Allah and spat in the well and its water gushed out. We made our animals drink from it and also drank from it. Next, the Muslim 3:1485. * Fath Al-Bari 6: 136. ' Fath Al-Bari 13:211. * Muslim 3 : 1486. ' FathAl-Bari 6

137 Sarah 48. Al-Fath (8-10) (Part-26 Messenger of Allah called the people to give the pledge when he was under the tree, and I was among the first to give the pledge to him. The remaining people then started giving the pledge. When about half the people have given the pledge, the Messenger[^] said to me, «Give me the pledge, O Salamah! I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! I have already pledged my pledge in the first group of people.’ He ﷺ said, «Do it again. So I pledged my pledge again. He also saw that I was not wearing any armor and gave me some. He went on accepting the pledge from the people. When they were about to finish, he said, i; ^8 «Wi7Z you not give me your pledge, O Salamah! I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! I have given you the pledge in the beginning and the middle.’ He ﷺ said, «Do it again, I gave him my pledge for a third time. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ asked me, J>\ ila3S jl o'- 1 iui “Where is the armor that I gave you O Salamah?» I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! ‘Amir met me and I found that he did not have a shield, so I gave it to him.’ The Messenger of Allah laughed and said to me, li Q\ ^ JLiill JjVi Jli «Yom are just like the man of old times who said, ‘O Allah! Give me a dear person who is dearer to me than myself.’ Then the idolators of Makkah sent a delegation asking for a peace treaty, and we agreed to make peace. I used to work for Talhah bin ‘Ubaydullah, may Allah be pleased with him, by

138 Tafsir Ibri Kathir providing water for his horse. For taking care of it, Talhah gave me a portion of his food. I had left my family and wealth and migrated to Allah and His Messenger (so I was poor). After the people of Makkah and us conducted peace and were freely mingling with each other, I went by a tree, removed its thorny branches and rested under its shade. Four of the idolators of Makkah stood close to me and started mentioning the Messenger of Allah ^ in an improper way and I hated being close to them. So, I moved under the shade of another tree. They hanged their weapons and rested under it. Meanwhile, a caller shouted these words from the bottom of the valley, ‘O Emigrants! Ibn Zaynaw was killed,’ so I held my sword and went after the four idolators. They were asleep, so I took possession of their weapons and held them in my hand, saying, “By He Who has honored the face of Muhammad ﷺ, if any one of you raises his head, I will strike that which holds his eyes!’ I brought them to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, while my uncle ‘Amir brought another mein, an idolator, whose name was Mikraz, and I and my uncle brought the men to the Messenger of Allah \$5 . The number of captured idolators swelled to seventy. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ looked at them and said, ‘Let them go, for theirs will be the initiation of hostilities and its burden .» The Messenger of Allah ﷺ forgave them and Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them.}[48:24]m ” Muslim collected a narration that is the same or similar. The Two Sahih recorded that Said bin Al-Musayyib said, “My father was among those who gave the pledge to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ under the tree. He said, In the following year, we went for Hajj and we could not find the tree.’ Therefore, if you I 1 * Dald’il An-Nubuwwah 4 :138 121 Muslim 1807.

know where that tree is, then you have more knowledge!”¹¹¹ Abu Bakr Al-Humaydi recorded that Jabir said, “When the Messenger of Allah called the people to the pledge, we found a man from our tribe whose name is Al-Jadd bin Qays, hiding under the shoulder of his camel.”^{*21} Muslim collected this Hadith³¹ Al-Humaydi also recorded that ‘Amr said that he heard Jabir say, “On the day of Hdaybiyyah, we were one thousand and four hundred and the Messenger of Allah S& said to us, 331 ' i_r®j x?- «Today, you are the best people on the earth.»” Jabir went on saying, “If I still had my sight, I would have shown you the tree.”¹⁴¹ Sufyan commented that the Companions later on differed over the location of the tree of Al-Hdaybiyyah; the Two Sahihs collected this statement from him . ¹⁵¹ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, a/jklJi jLa xZ-\ 3O 1 «None among those who gave the pledge under the tree shall enter HellfireJ {6] ‘Abdullah bin Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said that the Messenger of Allah said, Ja>* U CP c?1 c «He who ascends Thaniyyah (i.e. a mountainous pass), the Thatiyyah of Al-Murar, will have as much of his sins relieved for him as the sins that were relieved from the Children of Israeli The first to ascend that hill were the horsemen of (the Ansar tribe of) Banu Al-Khazraj, then the Muslims followed suit. The Prophet sgl said, ¹¹¹ Fath Al-Bdri 7:512, Muslim 3:1485. ¹²¹ Musnad Al-Humaydi 2 :537 ¹³¹ Muslim 3:1483. ^{*41} Musnad Al-Humaydi 2:514, Muslim no . 4811. ¹⁵¹ Fath Al-Bari 7 :507 , Muslim 3 :1484 ¹⁶¹ Ahmad 3:350.

Vi jiJi Vi 3 ^ “AH of you will be forgiven , except the owner of the red camel . We said to him, “Come, let the Messenger of Allah jg invoke Allah to forgive you,” but he said, “By Allah! Finding my lost camel is dearer to me than having your companion invoke Allah to forgive me.” That man was only looking for his lost camel. Muslim collected this Hadith from Ubaydullah (from Jabir). Muslim also recorded that Abu Az-Zubayr heard Jabir say, “Umm Mubashshir told me that she heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, while he was with Hafsah, •-^i JA <i>l il_i jj jQ | *Allah willing, none of the Companions of the tree, who gave the pledge under it, will ever enter Hellfire.o She said, ‘No, O Allah’s Messenger ’ The Prophet jg rebuked her but Hafsah said, Vi&o0 i There is not one of you but will pass over it (Hell)} (19:71) but the Prophet jg responded. j’ij \j& 0 :JuS 41)1 Jli tAlldh the Exalted said next, 4Tlxen We shall save those who had Taqwd and We shall leave the ivrongdoers therein on their biees0(19:71)’TM Muslim also narrated that Jabir said, “A slave of Hatib bin Abi Balta’ah came to the Messenger jg complaining against Hatib and saying, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Hatib shall surely enter Hell.’ The Messenger of Allah jg replied, KilloAJlj IjX jj^ V oJiS’n “You lie, he shall never enter the Fire; he participated in Badr and Al-Hdaybiyyah . «,3i This is why Allah the Exalted said while praising these Companions, Muslim 4 :2144. Muslim 4 :1942 Muslim 4 :1942

gross sjsTV, ijilJJaS \$CkipAjJpai J5 4J^ V ujCsUjiit^liiii j1313*1/^ •>L>^<jlb— ^ bybji La*-- AlV ^ rr -t if/" ^ j^5 ^ImJLjJjj^*JibJL>jb&JJU-ili^jLIL J-»UjAlil >z'*s^ • I !* * \ , 1/ u!t, JtfyX! !>i> Jp£ by a£t \$ Si j_rj jc Uili iSb ii' idc A|lt Lj jjt (Vj 53 *0P 4 Verily, those who give pledge to you, they are giving pledge to Allah. The Hand of Allah is over their hands. Then whoso- ever breaks his pledge, breaks it only to his own harm ; and ivhosoeverful- fills whatever covenant he has made with Allah, He will bestow on him a great reward.) Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said in another Ayah, O* «!>' ^ri, j£} i%£..} Zgi\& 4 c i&^&&J& il ilndeed, Allah was pleased with the believers xuhen they gave the pledge to you under the tree, He knew what was in their hearts, and He sent down tranquillity upon them, and He rewarded them with a near victory.) (48:18) u ifji u iipj na *£Vf sj ijssss & Jj^} jfc ji tju

jiji jl j£j jiji ul^ ^ yj J* |*4^4* 4 aLto (\$ iJi 4A- 1' v4^~i J J j* ! i*j at I5|i .AfAjj asC _l5 tji »J!l' ^4* 4 tli ijuuj »ti} o-J J-i*i AHj 4*S 4' lilt* 4l> <'r.Lw*- <*\$£«\$ £& at

111. Those of the bedouins who lagged behind will say to you: "Our possessions and our families occupied us, so ask forgiveness for us." They say with their tongues what is not in their hearts. Say: "Who then has any power at aV (to intervene) on your behalf with Allah, ifHe intends you hurt or intends you benefit? Nay, but Allah is Aware ofwhat you do.} 112. Nay, but you thought that the Messenger and the believers would never return to their families, and that was made fair seetning in your hearts, and you did think an evil thought and you became a Burn."} 413. And whosoever does not believe in Allah and His Messenger, then verily, We have preparedfor the disbelievers a blazing Fire.} 414. And to Allah belongs the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth. He forgives whom He wills, and punishes whom He wills. And Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Fabricated Excuse offered by Those Who lagged behind and did not participate in Al-Hudaybiyyah; Allah's Warning forThem Allah informs His Messenger jg of the excuses that the bedouins who lagged behind would offer him, those bedouins who preferred to remain in their homes and possessions and did not join the Messenger of Allah jg. They offered an excuse for lagging behind, as that of being busy - in their homes and with their wealth! They asked the Messenger of Allah \$g to invoke Allah to forgive them, not because they had faith in the Prophet jg and his invocation, but to show off and pretend. This is why Allah the Exalted said about them. £ o[<>*j 3* r+f# 4 1* > if} ojff} &4 3I 4They say with their tongues what is not in their hearts. Say: "Who then has any power at all (to intervene) on your behalf with Allah, ifHe intends you hurt or intends you benefit?"} Allah says, none can resist what Allah has decided in your case, all praise and honor belong to Him. Allah is the Knower of your secrets and what your hearts conceal, even if you

pretend and choose to be hypocritical with us. This is why Allah the Exalted said, 4P-Ip Cj iit 'J> }Nay, but Allah is Ever All-Aware ofwhat you do.} then He said, i<4 zfrPPj HP* s.} 4Nay, but you thought that the Messenger and the believers would never return to theirfamilies,} "for your lagging behind was not sin excusable act or just a sin. Rather, your lagging behind was because of hypocrisy and because you thought that the Muslims would be killed to the extent of extermination, their lives would be extinguished and none of them will ever come back,' iand you did think an evil thought and you became a people Biir} going for destruction, according to 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Mujahid and several others. 1 11 Qatadah explained Bur to mean, corrupt*2 ' and some said that it is a word used in the Arabic dialect of the area of Oman. Allah the Exalted then said, 4And whosoever does not believe in Allah and His Messenger,} Allah states here that whoever does not purify his actions outwardly and inwardly for Allah's sake, then Allah the Exalted will punish him in the Blazing Fire, even if he pretends to show people that he follows the faith, contradicting his true creed. Allah the Exalted then states that He is the Only Authority, King and Owner Who has full control over the residents of the heavens and earth. 4Cg £& iif %% ^ pi} 111 At-Tabari 22:214. '2| At-Tabari 22:214.

4He forgives whom He wills, and punishes whom He toills. And Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful.) with those who repent, return and submit to Him with humiliation. oi 4 2% uj, j?q&P « lif Jtt £jJ£, Ji % \ j3? ij& 415. Those who lagged behind will say, when you set forth to take the spoils, "Allow us to follow you." They want to change Allah's Words. Say: "You shall not follow us; thus Allah has said

beforehand." Then they will say: "Nay, you envy us." Nay, but they understand not except a little.) Allah characterizes the bedouins who lagged behind the Messenger of Allah during the Vmrah of Hudaybiyyah, saying that when the Prophet jg and his Companions later went on to conquer Khaybar, the bedouins asked them to take them along. They were hoping to collect war booty, having been absent when it was time to fight the enemy and enduring with patience therein. Allah the Exalted ordered His Messenger to refuse to give them permission to accompany him, being a punishment that is similar to their error. Allah has promised those who were present at Al-Hudaybiyyah to earn Khaybar's war spoils alone, not shared in that with the bedouins who lagged behind. Therefore, the legislation that Allah gave in this regard was joined to the destiny that He decided, occurring just as He decided. Allah's statement, iThey want to change Allah's Words), which refers to the promise that Allah gave those who were present at Al-Hudaybiyyah, according to the explanation reported from Mujahid, Qatadah, Juwaybir and which Ibn Jarir preferred. 111 Allah said, 4£\$ ifi ii' J'i CSii t i-X. 4Say: "You shall not follow us; thus Allah has said beforehand.") m At-Tabari 22 :215.

\x^fL>- tji \p5Cjj^ji-Jaj (1)UiSjiLjji fXjd SBaaKgi^ 'when He promised the participants of Al-Hudaybiyyah before you asked to join them,' 4&j5dU j ojyfj} 4Then they will say: "Nay, you envy us."} you do not want us to share the war spoils with you,' iU^ S££ V \& &} 4Nay, but they understand not except a little.> the truth is nothing close to what they claimed, but they understand not. *j>V>Vf Ji xX- ok. dj fy dl, oy-x—A ijLju OjiiJ j' j^>ui & &J c& & *& cr \$2&^# is jV^" 0; y-^ ifei Jij-i ^ j'J (£ J® £> (&iVf jc Vj Cu;^ Jjl; ^iSo\$^ I< Ail tfVSiMlf.-f ,v>i •< ali\$ / */ "itm"i ^ 1 ^ ^ 4 » /'• ^ J a1^«A3 <U3 > 416. Say to the bedouins who lagged behind: "You shall be called to fight against a people given to great warfare, then you shall fight them, or they shall surrender. Then if you obey, Allah will give you a fair reward; but if you turn away as you did turn away before, He will punish you with a painful torment."} 417. No blame or sin is there upon the blind, nor is there sin upon the lame, nor is there sin upon the sick. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, He will admit him to Gardens

beneath which rivers flow; and whosoever turns back, He will punish him with a painful torment. Allah conveys the News that there will be Many Cases of Jihad, and that Jihad distinguishes the Ranks of the Believers and exposes the Hypocrites. Scholars of Tafsir differ over who the people mentioned here are. They are people experienced at warfare who will be called to fight. There are many opinions, first, they are the tribe of Hawazin, as ShuTiah narrated from Abu Bishr from Said bin Jubayr, or Ikrimah, or both of them . Hushaym narrated this explanation from Abu Bishr, from both Said bin Jubayr and 'Ikrimah . 121 Qatadah, as narrated from him in one version, held the same view . 131 The second view is that these people are the tribe of Thaqif, according to Ad-Dahhak. The third view is that they are Banu Hanlfa, according to Juwaybir and Az-Zuhri, as Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated from him . 141 Similar was narrated from Said bin Jubayr and Ikrimah . 151 The fourth opinion is that they are the Persians, according to 'Ali bin Abi Talhah who reported that from 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas. This is also the view of 'Ata', Mujahid, and 'Ikrimah . 161 Ka'b Al-Ahbar said that they are the Romans , 171 while Ibn Abi Layla, 'Ata, Al-Hasan and Qatadah - in a different narration from him, said that they are the Persians and Romans . 1®1 Mujahid also said that they are the idolators . 191 In another narration Mujahid said, "They are men given to great warfare," and did not specify any particular people. This last explanation is the view preferred by Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Jarir. Allah's statement, 1,1 At-Tabari

22:220. At-Jabari 22:220. 131 At-Tabari 22:220. At-Tabari 22:220. [S] At-Tabari 22:220. At-Tabari 22:219, Al-Qurtubi 16:272. At-Tabari 22:221. At-Tabari 22:219. 191 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :520

y (*t\> iThen you shallfight them, or they shall surrender.} means, “you are called to fight them in Jihad, through constant warfare, until you become victorious over them or they surrender. Or, they will embrace your religion without a fight, but with their full consent.’ Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said next, i\+J, 4} iThen ifyou obey,} If you accept the call to Jihad and prepare for it and fulfill your duty in this regard,’ iAllah will give you a fair reward; but ifyou turn away as you turned away before,} ‘on the day of Al-Hudaybiyyah, when you were called to Jihad, yet lagged behind,’ 40) C’li p£s£&} iHe will punish you with a painful torment.} v4 Acceptable Reasons for notjoining Jihad Allah then mentions the legal reasons that allow one to be excused from joining the Jihad, such as blindness and being lame, and various illnesses that strike one and are remedied in few days. When one is ill, he is allowed to remain behind and will have a valid excuse to do so, until his illness ends. Allah the Exalted and Most honored then said, while ordaining joining the Jihad and obeying Allah and His Messenger 3^, 4^J~t tSfjL AfJ* Jjy-jy Sill cyj} iAnd whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, He will admit him to Gardens beneath which riversflow; and whosoever hims back,} from joining the Jihad and busies himself in his livelihood, C& %&} iHe will punish him with a painful torment.} in this life with

148 Tafstr Ibn Kathir humiliation and in the Hereafter with the Fire. Allah the Exalted has the best knowledge. J_/U 4 1* a* iii /jt- iii oSj VjJi-t l*Jj ai-SkSM 418. Indeed, Allah was pleased with the believers when they gave the pledge to you under the tree, He knew what was in their hearts, and He sent down As-Sakfnah upon them, and He rewarded than with a near victory.} 419. And abundant spoils that they will capture. And Allah is Ever All-Mighty, All-Wise.} Good News to the Participants ofthe Ridwan Pledge of Allah’s Pleasure and earning Spoils ofWar Allah declares that He is pleased with the believers who gave the pledge to the Messenger of Allah jg under the tree. We mentioned the number of these believers as being one thousand and four hundred and that the tree was a Samurah tree, located in the area of Hudaybiyyah. Al-Bukhari narrated from Tariq that ‘Abdur-Rahman said, “I went on Hajj and passed by people praying and asked, What is this Masjid?’ They said, This is the tree where the Messenger of Allah took the pledge of Ar-Ridwan.’ So, I went to Said bin Al- Musayyib and told him. Said said, ‘My father told me that he was among those who gave their pledge to the Messenger of Allah 5g under the tree. My father said: The following year, when we went out, we forgot its place and could not agree which tree it was.’ Said said, The Companions of Muhammad forgot where the tree was, but you know where it is. Therefore, you have better knowledge than them! ”I 1 Allah said, i’rr£ 4 £ 4He knezv what was in their hearts,} meaning, of truthfulness, trustworthiness, obedience and adherence, 4*^1J’ j\$} in FathAl-Bari 7:512.

and He sent down As-Sakinah}, calmness and tranquillity, iC.) Ci£££^ 4upon them, and He rewarded them with a near victory.} in reference to the goodness that Allah the Exalted and Most Honored caused to happened to the Companions on account of the peace treaty between them and their disbelieving enemies. Ever after that, the Companions gained abundant, general and continuous benefits and accomplishments, leading to the conquest of Khaybar and Makkah and then the various surrounding provinces and areas. They earned tremendous glory, triumphs and an elevated and honorable status in this life and in the Hereafter, just as Allah the Exalted said. 4And abundant spoils that they will capture.

And Allah is Ever All-Mighty, All-Wise. 420. Allah has promised you abundant spoils that you will capture, and He has hastened for you this, and He has restrained the hands of men from you, that it may be a sign for the believers, and that He may guide you to the straight path.} 421. And other (victories) which are not yet within your power; indeed Allah encompasses them. And Allah is Ever Able to do all things .} 422. And if those who disbelieve fight against you, they certainly would have turned their backs; then they would have found neither a protector nor a helper.} 423. That has been the way of Allah already with those who passed away before. And you will not find any change in the

150 Tafslr Ibn Kathir way of Allah.> 424. And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them. And Allah sees what you do.} Good News of abundant Spoils of War Mujahid said that Allah's statement, »J<jj=r=* ii' iAllah has promised you abundant spoils that you will capture,} refers to the spoils that Muslims earned up until this time, while, iand He has hastened for you this,} means, the conquest of Khaybar.*11 Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, iand He has hastened for you this,} means, "The peace treaty of Al-Hudaybiyyah."12' Allah said, u-CJt* Zsj } >-&)} iand He has restrained the hands of men from you,} meaning, 'no harm that your enemies had planned against you, both fighting and warfare, touched you. Allah also restrained the hands of men, whom you left behind close to your families and children, from harming them,' 4that it may be a sign for the believers,} with which they take heed and understand. Verily, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored shall help and protect the believers against all enemies, even though the believers are few in number. By doing so, the believers will come to know that Allah is truly the Knower of the consequences of all matters and that the best decisions are those which He prefers for His believing servants, even though At-Tabari 22:230. 121 AMabari 22:230.

these decisions might look unfavorable outwardly, 4'^=^ !£% J iflf} may be that you dislike a thing that is good for you} (2:216). Allah said, : U>>« iand that He may guide you to the straight path on account of your obeying His commands and adhering by His orders by following the path of His Messenger jg, GoodNews of continuous Muslim Victories u«hi the Day of Resurrection The statement of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored, 4'2^4* *(j>- ji \ffc- ijjjjj J £Aj} 4And other (victories) which are not yet within your power; indeed Allah encompasses them. And Allah is Ever Able to do all things.} Meaning, there are other war spoils and victories to come which are not within your grasp now. However, Allah will make them within your reach and indeed He compasses all these victories for your benefit. Surely, Allah the Exalted provides provisions and sustenance for His servants who have Taqwa, from resources they could never imagine. Scholars of Tafstr differ over the reference to other war spoils mentioned here. Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that it refers to the conquest of Khaybar.11 ' This meaning is sound according to the Ayah, 4-}& ±*£} 4and He has hastened for you this.} which refers to the treaty of Al-Hudaybiyyah . This is view of Ad-Dahhak, Muhammad bin Ishaq and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.121 Qatadah said that this part of the Ayah refers to the conquest of Makkah, and this opinion was preferred by Ibn Jarir.13 ' Ibn Abi Layla At-Tabari 22:233. AMabari 22:233-234. At-Tabari 22:234.

and Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that it refers to victories over the Persians and the Romans, 111 while Mujahid said that it refers to every victory and all spoils of war, until the Day of Resurrection . 121 Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented on the Ayah, iAnd other (victories) which are

not yet within your power; indeed Allah compasses them.}, “They are the victories that are continuing until this day.”¹³¹ Had Makkah’s Disbelievers fought at Al-Hudaybiyyah, They would have retreated in Defeat Allah said, *rpk-i S/J% Hp ctM\$2 %}* iAnd if those who disbelieve fight against you, they certainly would have turned their backs; then they would have found neither a protector nor a helper.} Allah the Exalted and Most Honored delivers the glad tidings to His believing servants that had the idolaters fought them, Allah would have given victory to His Messenger *sg* and His faithful servants. Then, the army of the disbelievers would have been defeated and would have deserted the battlefield and fled. They would not have found any helper or supporter, because they were fighting Allah, His Messenger *jg* and His Faithful Party. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, *fiS iUd la Jj i*That has been the way of Allah already with those who passed away before. And you will not find any change in the way of Allah.} means this is the way Allah deals with His creation. Whenever faith and disbelief meet at any distinguishing juncture, All&h m At-Tabari 22:233. 121 At-Tabari 22 :233 At-Tabari 22 : 233 mentioned that Ibn ‘Abbas commented, ‘They are the victories over Persia and Rome.” Mujahid added, “So go on earning victories until the Day of Resurrection.”

253 Surah 48. Al-Fath (20-24) (Part-26) gives victory to faith over disbelief, raises high truth and destroys falsehood. For instance, Allah the Exalted helped His loyal faithful supporters during the battle of Badr and they defeated His idolater enemies, even though the Muslims were few in number and lightly armed, while the idolaters were large in number and heavily armed. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said. *JA li oC ffr. feljj JiT jjjf 'jljfy 4*And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them. And Allah is Ever the All-Seer of what you do.} Allah the Exalted reminds His faithful servants of His favor when He restrained the hands of the idolaters, and thereby, no harm touched the Muslims from the idolaters. Allah restrained the hands of the believers and they did not fight the idolaters near Al-Masjid Al-Haram. Rather, Allah saved both parties from battle and brought forth a peace treaty that produced good results for the believers, in addition to, earning them the good end in this life and the Hereafter. We stated a Hadith from Salamah bin Al-Akwa‘ in which he narrated that when the Muslims brought forth those seventy idolator prisoners, they tied and paraded them before the Messenger of Allah *sg*, who looked at them and said. *is*, “Release them, so that they earn the burden of starting hostilities and its infamy .n* 1 Thereafter, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored sent down this Ayah about that incident, •-£ iSsi* Jij^ iAnd He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them...} Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “On the day of Hdaybiyyah, eighty armed men from Makkah went down the valley coming from Mount At-Tanlm to ambush the Messen- (il This appeared earlier

J 6!ii£5 o\t •='J-^~°_) 1}J& L-t-^ t* * •* J. m S^J'O-4 \ t\jZ<y> i*. -i^ ll_i) fl pOp»(^,^orfi'<PJpW^'l>^t?6=^^^ ^<k4JL^^^i'jiC|Oi^ f“ ll. Jc-a^k4^' pj J? 4\ ji> jJij Si O^i (n^ j^t) 4_»-0e J 4-And He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah, after He had made you victors over them.y 11 fl Muslim, Abu Dawud in his Sunan and At-Tirmidhi and An- Nasal, in the Tafsir section of their Sunan, collected this Hadxth.'2| r&%g J tp;& /p\ ^ '& <4\$ pb .'e •\.'>\ *• r •*' > *. {<, >/ . * >>'; 1 .1 *i ' l* *['/' * I xui J^jIJ jyo *-> (*-&>•*** V <—<>• *U-4j Ji*. ij^CLJ) OJi 4r~t \>JP OSi \J?j jj »Uj S* 4 Jcj iiJ iifi 1 i->" '44J 4 ib^ ^4' }i^ Pi -^UP) ui4) '>S 4ji^' *4^== ger of Allah 3gl. The Messenger ji invoked Allah against them, and they were taken prisoners.” ‘Affan added, “The Messenger 3g pardoned them, and this Ayah was later on revealed, 111*

Ahmad 3:122. 121 Muslim 3:1442, Abu Dawud 3:137, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 9 : 149

425. They are those who disbelieved and hindered you from Al- Masjid Al-Hardm and detained the sacrificial animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice. Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills - if they had been apart. We verily, would have punished with painful torment those of them who disbelieved 426. When those who disbelieve had put in their hearts pride and haughtiness - the pride and haughtiness of the time of ignorance, - then Allah sent down His calmness and tranquillity upon His Messenger and upon the believers, and made them stick to the word of Taqwa; and they were well entitled to it and worthy of it. And Allah is the All-Knower of everything. > Some of the Benefits gained from the Treaty at Al- Hudaibiyyah Allah the Exalted states that the Arab idolaters from Quraysh and their allies who extended help to them against His Messenger 5g, 4They are those who disbelieved>, they are indeed the disbelievers, 4£i\ £ 4and hindered you from Al-Masjid Al-Hardm> ‘even though you are its people and more worthy of being responsible for it,’ 4%% J 4and detained the sacrificial animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice.4 they prevented, because of transgression and stubbornness, the sacrificial animals from being reached to the place where they would be slaughtered. There were seventy sacrificial camels designated for sacrifice, as we will mention, Allah willing. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said,

iHad there not been believing men and believing women} living among the Makkans hiding their faith for fearing for their safety from the pagans. Otherwise, We would have given you authority over the Makkans and you would have killed them to the brink of extermination. However, there were some faithful believers, men and women, living among them, about whom you had no knowledge of being believers and you might try to kill them.’ Allah’s statement, && A }} iwhom you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you} an evil and erroneous act, o* 4 <3~0^ iwithout (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills} that Allah might delay the punishment of the pagans of Makkah to save the believers who lived among them, and so that many of the idolaters might embrace Islam. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, iif they had been apart}, if the disbelievers and the believers who were living among them had been apart, icJ C& £j%£&} 4We verily, would have punished with painful torment tlwse of them who disbelieved} *We would have given you dominance over the disbelievers and you would have inflicted tremendous slaughter on them.’ Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, (C+P& 4 iWhen those who disbelieve had put in their hearts pride and haughtiness - the pride and haughtiness of the time of ignorance,}

when they refused to write (in the treaty document), “In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful,’ and. These are the terms agreed on by Muhammad, Allah’s Messenger,’ ithen Allah sent down His calmness and tranquillity upon His Messenger and upon the believers and made than stick to the word of Taqwa;} the word of Taqwa refers to sincerity, according to Mujahid. ‘Ata’ bin Abi Rabah commented, “None has the right to be worshipped but Allah, alone without partners. All the dominion belongs to Him and all praise is due to Him. He is Ever Able to do eveiything.”*21 Yunus bin Bukayr

said that Ibn Ishaq narrated from Az-Zuhri, from Urwah, from Al-Miswar, commenting on, and made them stick to the word of Taqwa; } “La itaha illa Uah, alone without partners.” The Hadiths that tell the Story of Al-Hudaybiyyah and the Peace Treaty that followed Al-Bukhari, may Allah have mercy with him, recorded in his Sahih in ‘Book of Conditions’ that Al-Miswar bin Makhramah and Marwan bin Al-Hakam, both narrated attesting to the truthfulness of the other, “Allah’s Messenger jg set out at the time of Al-Hudaybiyyah with several hundred of his Companions. When he reached Dhul-Hulayfah, he had the sacrificial animals garlanded and marked and resumed the state of Ihram for Umrah. He then sent several men from the tribe of Khuza’ah to gather news for him and then he proceeded. When he arrived at a village called Al-Ashtat, his advance regiment came back and said. The Quraysh have gathered their forces against you, including Al-Ahlabish tribes.,³ ‘ They are intent on fighting you, stopping you, and preventing you.’ The Messenger jg said, At-Tabari 22:255. At-Tabari 22:256. ‘ Tribes living in the vicinity of Makkah

jjjji i* J?»j bjr?^° Uj lJxj (ji OjXjji i! Give me your opinion, O people! Do you think we should attack the families and offspring of those who seek to prevent us from reaching the House?*" in another narration, the Prophet jg said, Ji Jil iLl£ U_jlfc iSf-l* ifo' (Jii -1 ^ ii/ylSl 'bio'y^ V|3 Ji^ a Do you think we should attack the families of those who helped the Quraysh? If they come to defend against us, then Allah would have diminished the idolator forces. Or we leave them to grieve!*" In another narration, the Prophet jg said, Jiti ifiLi i£p o)j Csiyy 'j-**5 h-1** <J^D «JC£tf lip Uli •jZi jlji jf 'o'yj - J>-j a// they remain where they have gathered, they do so in grief, fatigued and depressed. If they save their families, it would be a neck that Allah the Exalted and Most Honored has cut off. Or, should we head towards the House and if anyone prevents us from reaching it we would fight them? “Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “O, Allah's Messenger! You only intended to visit the House, not to kill anyone or start a war. Therefore, head towards the House and whoever stands in our way, then we will fight him.” In another narration, Abu Bakr said, “Allah and His Messenger know that we only came to perform ‘Umrah not to fight anyone. However, anyone who tries to prevent us from reaching the House, we will fight him.” The Prophet sH said, •oil «Go forth then.* In another narration, the Prophet said, aGo forth, in the Name of Allah, the Exalted.

“When they proceeded for a distance, the Prophet jg said, S^~ cs? iy. jp" * # " uKhalid bin Al-WalTd is leading the cavalry of Quraysh forming the front of the army, so take the path on the right. By Allah, Khalid did not perceive the arrival of the Muslims until the dust arising from the march of the Muslim army reached him, then he turned back hurriedly to inform the Quraysh. The Prophet sg went on advancing until he reached the Thaniyyah (i.e., a mountainous way) through which he could reach them. The she-camel of the Prophet jg sat down. The people tried their best to cause her to rise, but it was in vain. So, they said, ‘Al-Qaswa’ has become stubborn! Al- Qaswa’ has become stubborn!’ The Prophet sg said, &Al-Qaswa’ has not become stubborn, for stubbornness is not her habit, but she was stopped by Him Who stopped the elephant .» Then he sg said, 'i/j 4Ul Ifi OyJh* \ *]a>- ji[ZS !;JL, «U15l “By the Name of Hun in Whose Hands is my sold, if they ask me anything which will respect the ordinances of Allah, the Exalted, I will grant it to them . The Prophet sg then rebuked the she-camel and she got up. The Prophet jg changed his direction, until he dismounted at the farthest end of Al-Hudaybiyyah. There was a pit containing a little water which the people used in small amounts, and after a short time the people exhausted all its water and complained of thirst to Allah’s Messenger jg.

The Prophet ^{sg} took an arrow out of his quiver and ordered them to put the arrow in the pit. By Allah, the water started flowing and continued sprouting until all the people quenched their thirst and returned satisfied. While they were still in that state, Budayl bin Warqa' Al- Khuza'i came with some people from his tribe, Khuza'ah. They were the advisers of Allah's Messenger ^{jg} who would keep no

secret from him and were from the people of Tihamah . Budayl said, I left (the tribes of) Ka'b bin Lu'ay and 'Amir bin Lu'ay residing at the abundant water of Al-Hudaybiyyah. They had milk camels with them, intending to wage war against you and prevent you from visiting the Katah.' Allah's Messenger said, \-J ^ Iy**? ~^s Vjj * 1 d)i 1 <3)1 j-Ljll jf '-U> SjA 'i-ki i_rr-4' «8^a! «We /taye not come to fight anyone, but to perform 'Umrah No doubt, war has weakened Quraysh and they have suffered great losses. So if they wish, I will conclude a truce with them, during which they should refrain from interfering between me and others. If I have victory over those infidels, Quraysh will have the option to embrace Islam as the other people do, if they wish. They will at least get strong enough to fight. But if they do not accept the truce, by Allah in Whose Hands my life is, I xvill fight with them defending my cause until I get killed, but (I am sure) Allah will definitely make His cause victorious.» Budayl said, 'I will inform them of what you have said.' So, he set off until he reached Quraysh and said, We have come from that man whom we heard saying something which we will disclose to you, if you should like.' Some of the fools among the Quraysh shouted that they were not in need of this information, but the wiser among them said, "Relate what you heard him saying.' Budayl said, I heard him saying such and such,' relating what the Prophet 3^5 had told him. "Urwah bin Mas'ud stood up and said, 'O people! Aren't you the sons?' They said, 'Yes.' He added, 'Am I not the father?' They said, 'Yes.' He said, T)o you mistrust me?' They said, 'No.' He said, 'Don't you know that I invited the people of Tjkaz for your help, and when they refused I brought my relatives and children and those who obeyed me?' They said, 'Yes.' He said, 1*1 An area about seventy two miles to the west of Al-Madinah.

Well, this man has offered you a reasonable proposal, it is better for you to accept it and allow me to meet him.' They said, 'You may meet him.' So, he went to the Prophet ^{jg} and started talking to him. The Prophet ^{sg} said the same to him as he had to Budayl bin Warqa. Then TJrwah said, 'O Muhammad! Won't you feel any qualms by exterminating your relations? Have you ever heard of anyone among the Arabs annihilating his relatives before you? On the other hand, if the reverse should happen, by Allah, I do not see dignified people here, but people from various tribes who would run away leaving you alone.' Hearing that, Abu Bakr verbally abused him and said, 'Go suck Al- Lat's womb! Are you saying we would run and leave the Prophet alone?' TJrwah said, Who is that man?' They said, 'He is Abu Bakr.' TJrwah said to Abu Bakr, 'By Him in Whose Hands my life is, were it not for the favor which you did to me and which I did not compensate, I would rebuke you.' TJrwah kept on talking to the Prophet ^{sg} and seizing the Prophet's beard as he was talking, while Al-Mughlrah bin Shu'bah was standing near the head of the Prophet ^{jg}, holding a sword and wearing a helmet. Whenever TJrwah stretched his hand towards the beard of the Prophet ^{jg}, Al-Mughlrah would hit his hand with the handle of the sword and say, 'Remove your hand from the beard of Allah's Messenger.' TJrwah raised his head and asked. Who is that?' The people said, 'He is Al- Mughlrah bin Shu'bah.' TJrwah said, 'O treacherous (one)! Am I not doing my best to prevent evil consequences of your treachery?' Before embracing Islam, Al-Mughlrah was in the company of some people. He killed them, took their property

and came (to Al-Madlnah) to embrace Islam. The Prophet jg said to him, jdi dj ijJti d» «As regards to your Islam, I accept it, but as for the property I do not take anything of it. TJrwah then started looking at the Companions of the Prophet jg. By Allah, whenever Allah's Messenger jg spat, the spittle would fall in the hand of one of them, who would rub it on his face and skin. If he ordered them, they would carry his orders immediately, if he performed ablution, they would

Now the matter has become easyfor you." Ma'mar said that Az-Zuhri narrated, "When Suhayl bin 'Amr came, he said to the Prophet 'Please conclude a peace treaty with us.' So, the Prophet jg called 'Ali bin Abi Talib and said to him, I ill^ 4i5l» Write: In the Name ofAllah, Ar-Ralunan, Ar-Rahim. Suhayl bin 'Amr said, 'As for Ar-Rahman, by Allah, I do not know what it means. So write: By Your Name, O Allah, as you used to write previously.' The Muslims said, "By Allah, we will not write except: By the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman, Ar- Rahlm.' The Prophet jg said, JiWL ,Jfi» *Wnte: "In Your NameO Allah ." Then he dictated, «4>l JjL'j aIU- U lJuU «77iis is a peace treaty, which Muhammad, Allah's Messenger has concluded. Suhayl said, *By Allah, if we knew that you are Allah's Messenger, we would not prevent you from visiting the Ka'bah, and would not fight with you. So, write: Muhammad bin 'Abdullah.' The Prophet jg said to him, <4il j, ilAi 4JSI tl)lj 4*1 <Jy ^yl 4)l_>» "By Allah! I am the Messenger ofAllah even ifyour people do not believe me. Write: "Muhammad bin 'Abdullah."*" Az-Zuhri continued, "The Prophet accepted all those things, since he had already said that he would accept everything they would demand if it respects the ordinance of Allah, the Exalted." The Hadith continues, "The Prophet jg said to Suhayl, «* 1 ^ ^ 1 1 r < 4j . l l l j l 'Ji «On the condition that you allow us to visit the House so that we may perform Tawafaround it. Suhayl said, *By Allah, we will not, so as not to give the Arabs

a chance to say that we have yielded to your pressure, but we will allow you next year.' So, the Prophet jg had that written. Then Suhayl said, "We also stipulate that you should return to us whoever comes to you from us, even if he embraced your religion.' The Muslims protested, 'Glorified be Allah! How can a person be returned to the idolators after he has become a Muslim?' While they were in this state Abu Jandal bin Suhayl bin 'Amr came from the valley of Makkah staggering with his chains and fell down among the Muslims. Suhayl said, 'O Muhammad! This is the very first term with which we make peace with you, that is, you shall return Abu Jandal to me.' The Prophet jgj said, «JbL' jj UJH "77ie peace treaty has not been written yet.» Suhayl said, Then by Allah, I will never conduct peace with you.'The Prophet said, "Release him to me,» and Suhayl responded, 1 will never allow you to keep him.'The Prophet ig said, "Yes, do . » He said, 1 will not.' Mikraz said. We allow you (to keep him).' Abu Jandal said, 'O, Muslims! Will I be returned to the idolators although I have come as a Muslim? Don't you see how much I have suffered?' Abu Jandal had been tortured severely for the cause ofAllah, the Exalted and Most Honored. TJmar bin Al-Khattab said, *1 went to the Prophet jg and said: Aren't you truly the Messenger of Allah?' The Prophet jg said, "Yes, indeed .» I said, Isn't our cause just and the cause of the enemy unjust?' He said, "Yes.o I said, Then why should we be humble in our religion?' He said, a.. re* I cJJj <ti)l u'!

«/ am Allah's Messenger and 1 do not disobey Him , and He will make me victorious . I said, 'Didn't you tell us that we would go to the Ka'bah and perform Tawafaround it?' He said, «^u3i jjt; i!f «Yes, but did I tell you that we ivould visit the Ka'bah this year?» I said, 'No.' He said, ^ ^ ^ — * £ «So you toil/

oisif if and perform Tawaf around it.» “Umar further said, ‘I went to Abu Bakr and said: O Abu Bakr! Isn’t he truly Allah’s Prophet?’ He replied, Yes.’ I said, Is not our cause just and the cause of our enemy unjust?’ He said. Yes.’ I said, Then why should we be humble in our religion?’ He said, ‘O you man! Indeed, he is Allah’s Messenger and he does not disobey his Lord, and He will make him victorious. Adhere to him for, by Allah, he is on the right path.’ I said, “Was he not telling us that we would go to the Ka’bah and perform Tawaf around it?’ He said, Yes, but did he tell you that you would go to the Ka’bah this year?’ I said, ‘No.’ He said, You will go to the Ka’bah and perform Tawaf around it.’ Az-Zuhri said, “Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said, “I performed many good deeds as expiation for the improper questions I asked them.’ ” “When the writing of the peace treaty was concluded, Allah’s Messenger said to his Companions, iGet up and slaughter your sacrifices and have your heads shaved .» By Allah none of them got up, and the Prophet jg repeated his order thrice. When none of them got up, he left them and went to Umm Salamah and told her of the people’s attitudes towards him. Umm Salamah said, ‘O Prophet of Allah! Do you want your order to be carried out? Go out and don’t say a word to anybody until you have slaughtered your sacrifice and call your barber to shave your head.’ The Messenger of Allah

166 Tafsir Ibn Kathir M went out and did not talk to anyone until he did what she suggested, slaughtered the sacrifice and shaved his head. Seeing that, the Companions got up, slaughtered their sacrifices, and started shaving the heads of one another. There was so much of a rush - and sadness - that there was a danger of killing each other. Then some believing women came and Allah the Exalted and most Honored revealed the following Ayat, i fii. rp: 2\$ 40 you who believe! When believing women come to you} (60:10), until, iLikewise hold not the disbelieving women as wives.} Tjmar then divorced two of his wives, who were disbelievers. Later on Mu’awiyah bin Abu Sufyan married one of them, and Safwan bin Umayyah married the other. When the Prophet jg returned to Al-Madinah, Abu Basir, a new Muslim convert from the Quraysh, came to him. The disbelievers sent two men in pursuit who said to the Prophet Sjt, ‘Abide by the promise you gave us.’ So, the Prophet jg handed him over to them. They took him out (of Al-Madinah) until they reached Dhul-Hulayfah where they dismounted to eat some dates they had with them. Abu Basir said to one of them, “By Allah, O, so-and-so, I see you have a fine sword.’ The other drew it out (of its sheath) and said, ‘Yes, by Allah, it is very fine and I have tried it many times.’ Abu Basir said, let me have a look at it.’ When the other gave the sword to Abu Basir, he struck him with it until he died. His companion ran away until he reached Al-Madinah, entering the Masjid running. When Allah’s Messenger jg saw him he said, Ijla jfj oijD »77u’s man appears to have been frightened.» When he reached the Prophet he said, *My companion has been murdered, by Allah, and I would have been murdered too.’ Abu Basir came and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger, by Allah! Allah has made you fulfill your obligations by returning me to them, but Allah the Exalted has saved me from them.’ The »-

Prophet sg said, «Jb-f iii atf ‘ji «Woe to his mother! What an excellent war kindler he would be, if he only have supporters . When Abu Basir heard this from the Prophet jg, he understood that he would return him to the idolaters again, so he set off until he reached the seashore. Abu Jandal bin Suhayl also got himself released from the disbelievers and joined Abu Basir. Thereafter, whenever a man from Quraysh embraced Islam he would follow Abu Basir until they formed a strong group. By Allah, whenever they heard about a caravan of the Quraysh heading towards Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), they

stopped it, attacked and killed the disbelievers and took their properties. The people of Quraysh sent a message to the Prophet ﷺ requesting him for the sake of Allah and kith and kin to send for (Abu Basir and his companions) promising that whoever among them came to the Prophet ﷺ, would be secure. So, the Prophet ﷺ sent for them and Allah the Exalted and Most Honored revealed the following Ayat, 4r^l |*r iAnd He it is Who has withheld their hands from you and your hands from them in the midst of Makkah), until, 4the pride and haughtiness of the time of ignorance,) Their pride and haughtiness was that they did not confess that Muhammad ﷺ was the Prophet of Allah, refused to write,

In the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman, Ar-Rahim,' and prevented

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5451–5454]

Muslims from visiting the Kabah.”¹¹¹ This is the narration Al-Bukhari collected in the Book of Ta'sfir,,a| 'Umrat Al-Hudaybiyyah , ' ' Hajj, and so forth.¹⁴ Allah is the Only One sought for help, all reliance is on Him alone and there is no ¹¹¹ Path Al-Bari 5 :388 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :451 131 Path Al-Bari 7:518. 141 Fath Al-Bari 3 :634

168 Tafsir Ibn Kathir might or strength except from Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise. Al-Bukhari narrated in the Book of Tafsir that Habib bin Abi Thabit said that he went to Abu Wa'il asking him about something and he said, "We were at Siffin, when a man said, "Do you not see those who call to Ali's Book?" 'Ali bin Abi Talib said, 'Yes.' Sahl bin Hunayf said, 'Do not feel certain in the reliability of your own opinions! On the day of Hudaibiyyah, the day the treaty of peace was signed between the Prophet ﷺ and idolators, had we found a chance to fight, we would have done so.' 'Umar came (to the Prophet ﷺ) and said, 'Are we not on the true cause and theirs is the false cause? Are not our killed in Paradise and theirs in the Fire?' He said, *Yes.' "Umar said, "Why then should we be humble with regards to the cause of our religion? Why should we go back before Allah decides in the matter between us (between Muslims and the idolators.)' The Prophet ﷺ said, "Ijil <1>1 <1>1 willaijl ^1 lit «0 son of Al-Khattab! I am Allah's Messenger and He will never abandon me . "Umar left while feeling angry and soon went to Abu Bakr and said, 'O Abu Bakr! Are we not on the true cause and they are on falsehood?' Abu Bakr said, 'O son of Al-Khattab! He is Allah's Messenger and Allah will never abandon him.' Surat Al-Fath was later revealed." Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith in several other parts of his Sahih, and so did Muslim and An-Nasab using various chains of narration from Abu Wa'il, Sufyan bin Salamah, from Sahl bin Hunayf. Some of these narrations read, "O people! Accuse sheer opinion (of being imperfect)! On the day Abu Jandal came, I saw myself willing to reject the command of Allah's Messenger ﷺ, had I had the chance." In yet another narration, "Surat Al-Fath was revealed and the Messenger of Allah ﷺ called "Umar bin Al-Khattab and recited it to him." Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said, "Quraysh resorted to peace with the Prophet ﷺ. Suhayl bin 'Amr was among the HI Fath Al-Bari 8 :45 1

169 Surah 48. Al-Fath (25-26) (Part-26) idolators then. The Prophet ﷺ said to 'Ali, «Write: "In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful." Suhayl said, "We do not know the meaning of: In the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim. However, write what we do know: In Your Name, O Allah!' The Messenger ﷺ said, "Write: "From Muhammad, Allah's Messenger and Suhayl said, *If we knew that you are Allah's Messenger, we would have followed you. However, write your name and the

name of your father.' The Prophet ﷺ said, $\text{d} \leq \text{j} \text{ l}$ Jus J> IfA "Write: 'From Muhammad son of 'Abdullah They set the terms with the Prophet ﷺ that, *If anyone comes from your side to us, we will not send him back to you. If anyone from among us came to you, you send him back to us.' 'Ali said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Should I write this,' and the Prophet ﷺ said, C $\text{4j} \text{ l}$ s j j o i i J b i f j A "Yes. Surely, those who revert from our side and go to them, then may Allah cast them atum/V * Muslim also collected this Hadith."|2 Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said, "When Al- Haruriyyah rebelled, they set a separate camp for their group. I said to them, 'On the day of Al-Hudaybiyyah, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ agreed to conduct peace with the idolators. He said to 'Ali, j a l l p U 1 J u k . < . U "Write, O 'Ali : "These are the terms agreed to by Muhammad, Allah's Messenger.")' 111 Ahmad 3:268. Muslim 3 : 14 1 1

The idolators said, If we knew that you are Allah's Messenger, we would not have fought you. ' Allah's Messenger said, ^ If? ^ ^ 4 i i i i ^ i p u ^ i i » • < i i i • - > ^ o i « i U "O 'Ali! Erase it. O Allah! You know that I am Your Messenger. O 'Ali! Erase it and write instead: "These are the peace terms agreed to by Muhammad bin 'Abdullah." By Allah, Allah's Messenger ^ is better than 'Ali, and the Messenger erased his title. However, erasing his title did not mean that he was erased from being a Prophet. Have I given you sufficient proof in this.' They said, 'Yes.'""* 11 Abu Dawud also collected a similar narration.^2 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said, "On

the day of Hudaybiyyah, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ slaughtered

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5454–5466]

seventy sacrificial camels, including a camel that belonged to Abu Jahl. When the camel was prevented from coming to the House, she cried just as she would cry when seeing her offspring."131 && a c # f a t s u 63 < 5 # & * v z 1 A 2 ? C p V U t & j f e j f j . i & l ^ o t p f & y i j J j y j 4 2 7 . Indeed Allah shall fulfill the true vision which He showed to His Messenger in very truth. Certainly, you shall enter Al- Masjid Al- Hardm, if Allah wills, secure, (some) having your heads shaved, and (some) having your hair ad short, having no fear. He knew what you knew not, and He granted besides that a near victory. 428. He it is Who has sent His Messenger with guidance and the religion of truth, that He may make it superior to all religions. And All-Sufficient is Allah as a Witness. Ahmad 1:342. Abu Dfiwud 3:317. (3) Ahmad 1 :314.

Allah has indeed fulfilled the True Vision which He showed to His Prophet In a dream, the Messenger of Allah saw himself entering Makkah and performing Tawaf around the House. He told his Companions about this dream when he was still in Al- Madinah. When they went to Makkah in the year of Al- Hudaybiyyah, none of them doubted that the Prophet's vision would come true that year. When the treaty of peace was conducted and they had to return to Al-Madinah that year, being allowed to return to Makkah the next year, some of the Companions disliked what happened. 'Umar bin Al- Khattab asked about this, saying, "Haven't you told us that we will go to the House and perform Tawaf around it?" The Prophet ﷺ said. i Yes. Have I told you that you will go to it this year?» Umar said, "No." The Prophet ﷺ said, H j j 4 j ! J j U J i D "Then you will go to it and perform Tawaf around it." Umar received the same answer from Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, letter for letter.' ' This is why Allah the Exalted and Most honored said, X L o > 4 Indeed Allah shall fulfill the true vision which He showed to His Messenger in very truth. Certainly, you shall enter Al- Masjid Al-Hardm, if Allah wills, } and He willed

that this matter shall certainly occur, {^f} {secure,} means, *upon your entering,' {(some) having your heads shaved, and (some) having your hair cut short,} 111 Fath Al-Bari 5 :390

172 TafsTr Ibn Kathtr and some of them indeed had their head hair shaved, while some of them had their head hair shortened. The Two Sahihs recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, Jil «0 Allah! Be merciful to those who have their head shaved .» The people said, “O Allah’s Messenger! And (invoke Allah for) those who get their hair cut short.” He jg said, “O Allah! Be merciful to those ivho have their head shaved .» The people said, “O Allah’s Messenger! And those who get their hair cut short.” The Prophet jg said, «0 Allah! Be merciful to those who have their head shaved .» The people said, “O Allah’s Messenger! And those who get their hair cut short.” The Prophet jg said (the third or the fourth time), “And to those who get their hair cut short Allah said, Li ihavhig no fear}, indicating that they will be safe and will have no fear when they enter Makkah. This occurred in the Vmrah performed the following year, on the seventh year of Hijrah during the month of Dhul-Qa’dah. When the Messenger sg left from Al-Hudaybiyyah, during the month of Dhul-Qa’dah (the sixth year of Hijrah), he went back to Al-Madlnah. He remained in Al-Madinah during the months of Dhul-Hijjah and Al-Muharram. In Safar, he marched forth to Khaybar, and Allah opened that city for him, partly by force and partly by its people surrendering to him. Khaybar was a wealthy province that had abundant date trees and vegetation. The Prophet jg hired the (defeated) Jews of Khaybar to attend |i| Fath Al-Bari 3 :656, Muslim 2 :946.

to a part of its green fields and divided the province among those who attended Al-Hudaybiyyah with him. No one else except those Companions took part in attacking Khaybar, except Ja'far bin Abi Talib, who came back with his companions from Ethiopia. Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari and his people also attended that battle. None of them were absent except Abu Dujanah Simak bin Kharashah, according to Ibn Zayd. 111 This fact is well recorded in (the Books of) history. The Prophet sg then returned to Al-Madlnah. When the month of Dhul-Qa’dah came, the seventh year of Hijrah, the Prophet jg went to Makkah for 'Umrah accompanied by those who were with him at Al-Hudaybiyyah. He resumed Ihram from Dhul-Hulayfah and took the sacrificial animals with him. It was said that the sacrificial animals were sixty. The Prophet jg and his Companions started reciting the Talbiyah aloud. When they came close to Marr Az-Zahran, he sent Muhammad bin Maslamah before him with the horses and weapons. When the idolators saw this advance regiment, they were overwhelmed with fear. They thought that the Messenger of Allah ag would attack 'hem and that he had betrayed the treaty that he conducted with them, which stipulated cessation of hostilities for ten years. The idolators went quickly to Makkah to inform its people. When the Prophet ag made camp in the area of Marr Az-Zahran, where he was close enough to see the idols that were erected all around the Haram, he sent the weaponry, arrows, arrow cases and spears, to the valley of Ya'jaj. He next went on his way towards Makkah with the swords resting in their sheaths, just as he agreed to in the peace treaty. While the Prophet jg was still on the way to Makkah, the Quraysh sent Mikraz bin Hafs who said, “O Muhammad! We never knew you to be one who betrays his promises.” The Prophet sg said, •Villi •Why do you say that?» Mikraz said, “You are headed towards us with the weaponry, the arrows and the spears.” The Prophet ag said, HT At-Tabari 22 :259.

«Efl; Jij Jus s& jj» “/ did not do that, I sent all that to the valley of Ya'jajj Mikraz said, “This is the way we knew you to be, trustworthy and keeping to your promises.” The leaders of the disbelievers left Makkah so that they would not have to look at the Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions, out of rage and anger. As for the rest of the people of Makkah, men, women and children, they sat on the pathways and house roofs watching the Messenger of Allah jg and his Companions. The Messenger entered Makkah with his Companions while reciting the Talbiyah. The Prophet jg sent the sacrificial animals to Dhu Tuwa while riding his camel, Al-Qaswa', the same camel he was riding on the day of Hdaybiyyah. 'Abdullah bin Rawahah, from Al-Ansar, was holding the bridle of the Prophet's camel and repeating this poem, “In the Name of He, other than Whose religion there is no true religion, In the Name of He, Whom Muhammad is His Messenger, O children of the disbelievers, stay out of his way, For today, we shall impose on you the fulfillment of its interpretation, Just as we fought with you to accept its revelation, Severe fighting that removes the heads from where they rest, And overwhelms the companion from attending to his companion, Ar-Rahmfin has sent down in His revelation, In pages that are being recited before His Messenger, That the best death is that which occurs in His cause, So, O Lord, I believe in its statements.” This story is collected from various narrations. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said, “When Allah's Messenger jg and his Companions came to Makkah, the fever of Yathrib (Al-Madinah) had weakened and bothered them. The idolators circulated the news that a group of people were coming to them and that they had been weakened and bothered by the fever of Yathrib (Al-Madinah). The idolators sat in the area close to Al-Hijr. Allah conveyed to His Prophet what the idolators said, so he ordered his Companions to do RamcU. in the first three rounds, so that the

idolators witness their strength. The Companions did Ramal the first three rounds. He also ordered them to walk normally between the two comers, for from there the idolators would not be able to see them. The Prophet jg did not order them to do Ramal in all the rounds of Tawafout of pity for them. The idolators commented, 'Are these the people whom you claimed were weakened by the fever. They are stronger than so-and- sol''' ' The Two Sahihs also recorded this Hadith^ In another narration, “Allah's Messenger jg and his Companions came (to Makkah) on the morning of the fourth day of Dhul-Qa'dah. The idolators circulated the news that a group of people was coming to them, who had been weakened by the fever of Yathrib (Al-Madlnah). So, the Prophet jg ordered his Companions to do Ramal in the first three rounds of Tawaf. The Prophet 5g did not order them to do Ramal in all the rounds of Tawafout of pity for them.”¹³¹ Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, “In the year when the Prophet jg came as stipulated by the peace treaty, he said, 'Perform Ramal.' So that the idolators may witness their strength. At that time, the idolators were watching from the area of Qu'ayqi'&n.(4* ” Ibn 'Abbas said, “Allah's Messenger sg performed Tawaf of the Kahah and the Sa'i/6 ' at As-Safa and Al-Marwah to show his strength to the idolators.” ¹⁷¹ Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin TJmar said, “Allah's Messenger sg set out for 'Umrah, but the Quraysh idolators prevented him from reaching the Ka'bah. So, he slaughtered his sacrifice, got his head shaved at Al-Hdaybiyyah, agreed to a formal pact with them that he would perform 'Umrah the following year, would not carry weapons against them, except swords and would not stay in Makkah, except for the period they allowed. The Prophet sg performed the Umrah in the I1 ' Ahmad 1 :294. 121 Fath Al-Bari 7 :581 , Muslim 2 :923 131 Fath Al-

Bari 3 :548 The small hill towards the Hijr. 151 FathAl-Bari 7:581. I6 ' Walking at a fast pace 171 Fath. Al-Bari 7:581.

following year and entered Makkah according to the treaty. And when he stayed for three days, the idolators ordered him to depart, and he departed.” Allah’s statement, -dJb iHe knew what you kneiv not, and He granted besides that a near victory.} means, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored knew the benefit and goodness of turning you away from Makkah and preventing you from entering it in the year of Al-Hudaybiyyah, He knew that which you had no knowledge of. iand He granted besides that 'before entering Makkah as you were promised in the vision that the Prophet saw. He granted a close victory, i.e. the treaty of peace that you conducted between you and your idolator enemies.’ The Good News that Muslims will conquer the Known World, and ultimately the Entire World Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, while delivering the glad tidings to the believers that the Messenger jg will triumph over his enemies and the rest of the people of the earth, iHe it is Wlw has sent His Messenger with guidance and the religion of truth,} with beneficial knowledge and righteous good deeds. Indeed, the Islamic SharVah has two factors, knowledge and deeds. The true religious knowledge is by definition true, and the accepted Islamic acts are by definition accepted. Therefore, the news and creed that this religion conveys are true and its commandments are just, 4*4^=* sW*’ ,v ithat He may make it superior to all religi- ons.} all the religions of m FathAl-Bari 7 :571 .

177Surah 48. Al-Fath (29) (Part-26) ^ 'A, 0 \ 0 mmsm JC-iUilxijM 41)'J >Aw f ^ *# A > . <lE j~ -‘^ .S .A *1^ -. ?Tj->- \ ^ ;i±:i: .f> * ^ .«* * f; >> u~J*£-j)->rJ *j*?1 a. ^ « yy ^> >>XV/ * i X # | - y ^ ai->i au(Jrt>Xt OjXij a&gf 74_im <ul 4A> jt JUJ '• .< :< r v.” /; > {‘& *”. {j* X^a* JjiCjj ‘-Afw UOj > a *a. Y'f*’ r ' 5f J pAU-«-< *tt’ j: ^ # »££ } s 4^^ si< a x; ;*&k ^ xs p\ 4x; s ^xs Xins ;sui ,ixi cXyji" iy^cj i^>u the people of the earth, Arabs and non- Arabs alike, whether having certain ideolo- gies or being atheists or idolators. *v%m 4And All-Sufficient is Allah as a Witness. that Muhammad jjg is His Messenger and that He will grant him victory. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored has the best knowledge. 429. Muhammad is the Messenger ofAllah. And those who are with him are severe against disbelievers, and merciful among themselves. You see them bowing falling down prostrate, seeking rewardfrom Allah and acceptance. The mark of them is on their faces from the traces of prostration. This is their description in the Tawrah. But their description in the Injil is like a seed zuhich sends forth its shoot, then makes it strong, and becomes thick and it stands straight on its stem, delighting the sowers, that He may enrage the disbelievers zoith them. Allah has promised those among them who believe and do righteous good deeds, forgiveness and a mighty reward.

1Z8 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Qualitiesofthe Faithful BelieversandTheirRefinement Allah declares that without doubt, Muhammad^ is truly His Messenger, 4& Sji 4Muhammad is the Messenger ofAllah. and this quality includes every beautiful description. Allah praises the Companions of the Messenger sg, may Allah be pleased with them all, iAnd those who are with him are severe against disbelievers, merciful among themselves just as He, the Exalted and Most Honored, said in anotherAyah, -}Si <jk. Sf-t} iAllah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him; humble towards the believers, stem towards the disbelievers.^(5:54) This is the description of the believers; harsh with the disbelievers, merciful and kind to the believers, angry without smiling before the disbelievers, smiling and beriming with pleasure before his believing brother. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, 40 you

who believe! Fight those of the disbelievers who are close to you, and let them find harshness in you.} (9:123) The Prophet sg said, *The parable of the believers in their kindness and mercy for each other, is that of the body : when one of its organs falls ill, the rest of the body responds with fever and sleeplessness.^ The Prophet sg also said, , l > .. t ygH c*'A jtA> m Muslim 4 :1999

“A believer to another believer is like a building whose different parts enforce each otherj Then he clasped his hands with his fingers interlaced. 1 11 Both of these Hadiths were collected in the Sahih. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4You see them bowing and falling down prostrate, seeking rewardfrom Allah and acceptance.} Allah describes the believers as active in performing righteous deeds and in praying, which is the best action there is, all the while being sincere to Allah the Exalted and Most Honored in the prayer, awaiting His generous reward alone. Allah’s best reward is Paradise that contains His bounties and favors, abundant provisions, as well as, earning His good pleasure that is greater than the former reward. Allah said, 4j^=^\$ 4But the greatest bliss is the acceptance by Allah (9:72) The statement of Allah the Exalted next, 4The mark of them is on their faces from the traces of prostration.} refers to graceful appearance, according to Ibn ‘Abbas as reported from him by ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah.12 ’ Mujahid and several others explained: “It means, humbleness and reverence. ”,31 Some said, “The righteous good deed brings light to the heart, brightness to the face, ampleness in provisions, and love in people’s hearts.” The Leader of the faithful, TJthman bin ‘Affan stud, “Everyone who hides a secret, then Allah the Exalted will either show on his face what he’s done or by the words that accidentally slip from his mouth.” Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas said that

the Prophet jg said. m Fath Al-Bari 5:119. At-Jabari 22 :263 131 At-Tabari 22 :263

Messenger jg. They gave the Messenger aid, support and victory, just as the shoot hardens the plant, 4that He may enrage the disbelievers with them> Relying on this Ayah, Imam Malik stated that the Rawafid are disbelievers because they hate the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them all. Malik said, “The Companions enrage them, and according to this Ayah, he who is enraged by the Companions is a disbeliever.” Several scholars agreed with Malik’s opinion, may Allah be pleased with them. There are numerous Hadiths mentioning the virtues of the Companions and prohibiting the criticism on their mistakes. It is sufficient that Allah the Exalted has praised them and declared that He is pleased with them. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4Allah has promised those among them zoho believe and do righteous deeds, forgiveness> for their sins, iand a mighty reward . a generous reward and honorable provisions. Certainly, Allah’s promise is true and shall come to pass and will never be broken or changed. Surely, all those who follow the guidance of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them all, will be similar to them. However, the Compa- nions have the better virtue, the obvious lead and the perfection in character, on account of which none among this Ummah will be able to attain their level. May Allah be pleased with them and make them pleased. May He place them in the gardens of Al-Firdaws, and make it their abode, and He indeed has done all of that. In his Sahlh, Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, U i L*j jL* jl ^ 1 JU iljii m A category of Shiites

•Do not abuse my Companions, for by the One in Whose Hand is my soul! If one ofyou spends the amount of Uhud in gold, that amount will never reach the level ofone of them spending a Mudd half of it.s,1!

Surah 49: Al-Hujurat

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Hujurat

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5467–5469]

(Chapter - 49) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah 5g! P In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. # \& \%Vi P&% H \\$X J •PP. fPS '£ op j£jpt rpj; \fX \$ P 3yf>V&& oJP j\$ k©V* V^ j£K2 -**!}* -**'J >4^ 4>t t 42 . O you who believe! Make not (a decision) in advance before Allah and His Messenger, and have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Hearing, Knowing.} 42 . O you who believe! Raise not your voices above the voice of the Prophet, nor speak aloud to him in talk as you speak aloud to one another, lest your deeds should be thwarted while you perceive not.} 43. Verily, those who lower their voices in the presence of Allah's Messenger, they are the ones whose hearts Allah has tested for Taqwa. For them is forgiveness and a great reward.}

The Prohibition of making a Decision in advance of Allah and His Messenger; ordering Respect towards the Prophetg In these Ayat, Allah the Exalted teaches His faithful servants the good manners they should observe with the Messenger jg, which are respect, honor and esteem. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4Vi P&i 'y'P i \pt 0\$ you who believe! Make not (a decision) in advance before Allah and His Messenger,}

meaning, do not rush in making decisions before him, rather, follow his lead in all matters. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, commented; i ujj ijiojj iMake not (a decision) in advance before Allah and His Messenger,} "Do not say anything that contradicts the Qur'an and Sunnah."111 Qatadah commented, "We were told that some people used to say, 'Revelation should be sent down about such and such matters,' and, 'such and such practices should be rendered allowed.' Allah the Exalted disliked this attitude."^2 ' Allah said, 4and have Taqwa of Allah. meaning, 'in what He has ordered you;' iya& 4 Verily, Allah is Hearing,} "your statements," Allah said, i'0 4Knowing "your intentions." ifop\$po rps v p: <\$ 40 you who believe! Raise not your voices above the voice of the Prophet,} This contains another kind of favorable behavior. Allah the Exalted is teaching the believers that they should not raise their voices above the voice of the Prophet sg. It was stated that this Ayah was revealed about Abu Bakr and TJmar. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said, "The two righteous ones, Abu Bakr and 'Umar, almost earned destruction when they raised their voices before the Prophet sg who was receiving the delegation of Bani Tamlm. One of them 111 At-Tabari 22:275. At-Tabari 22:276.

185Surah 49. Al-Hujurd (1-3) (Part-26) recommended AI-Aqra' bin Habis the member of the Banu Mujashi' while the other recommended smother man. Nafi' (a subnarrator) said: "I don't remember his name." Abu Bakr said to 'Umar, 'You only wanted to contradict me,' while 'Umar said, "I did not

intend to contradict you.' Their voices then became loud, thereupon Allah the Exalted sent down this Ayah, -V J pj y ip: 'Ji pp Ip Jpq iO you who believe! Raise not your voices above the voice of the Prophet, nor speak aloud to him in talk as you speak aloud to one another, lest your deeds should be thwarted while you perceive noty 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said, "After that, 'Umar's voice was so low that the Messenger of Allah had to ask him to repeat what he said so that he could understand what he was saying to him." 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr did not mention the same

regarding his father, Abu Bakr,[1! may Allah be pleased with

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5469–5470]

him. 121 Muslim did not collect this Hadith. In another narration collected by Al-Bukhari, he said that a delegation from the tribe of Banu Tamlm came to the Prophet 4§ and that Abu Bakr recommended Al-Qa'qa' bin Ma*bad to be appointed as their leader, while 'Umar recommended Al- Aqra* bin Habis.*3 * Muslim did not collect this narration. Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said, "The Prophet *3 missed Thabit bin Qays and a man said, 'O Allah's Messenger! I will find out about his news.' That man went to Thabit and found him sitting at home with his head lowered and asked him, What is the matter?' Thabit said, 'An evil matter!' And he said that he used to raise his voice above the voice of the Prophet sg. He feared that his good deeds would be useless and he would be among the people of the Fire. The man went back to the Prophet and conveyed Thabit's statement and returned to Thabit with a wonderfully good Meaning his grandfather. FathAl-Bari 8:454. 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :457

news. The Prophet sg said, «&Jl j* Jjkij ijllll pi^ oJ-J iw : jj jii dl 4^il» iGo back to him and tell him this news; you are not among the people of the Fire. Rather, you are among the dwellers of Paradise Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith with this wording. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, "When this Ayah was revealed, ifop& \$*> 40 you who believe! Raise not your voices above the voice of the Prophet}, until, iwhile you perceive not}, Thabit bin Qays bin Ash-Shammas, whose voice was loud, said, 1 was the one who raised his voice above the voice of Allah's Messenger jg. I am among the dwellers of the Fire. My good deeds have been done in vain.' He remained in his house feeling distressed, and the Messen- ger of Allah jg noticed his absence. So some men went to Thabit and said to him, The Prophet% noticed your absence.

What is the matter with you?' Thabit said, 1 used to raise my

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5470–5498]

voice above the voice of the Prophet *g and speak loudly in front of him. My deeds have been rendered useless and I am among the people of the Fire.' They went to the Prophet and told him what Thabit said and the Prophet sg said, S* 3? <tNay, he is among the dwellers ofParadise Anas commented, "We used to see Thabit walk among us knowing that he was (to be) among the dwellers of Paradise. During the battle of Yamamah, our forces suffered retreat. Suddenly, Thabit bin Qays bin Shammas came, having put on his Hanuf 2] and shrouds, and said, The worst habit is the one you acquire from your enemy and do not set a bad 111 FathAl-BOri8:454. ' Fragrance used when shrouding the dead for burial

187 Surah 49. Al-Hujurat (1-3) (Part-26) example for your companions.' And he went on fighting until he was martyred, may Allah be pleased with him."11 Allah then prohibited speaking to the Prophet ﷺ in a loud voice, just as one speaks loudly to another in a way that offends him. Instead, they were required to speak to him in terms of respect, honor and calmness. This is why Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, *40j£ inor speak aloud to him in talk as you speak aloud to one another,* just as He said in another Ayah, *4Uuo ^j} 4Make not the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one of another.* (24:63) Allah's statement, *ilest your deeds should be thwarted while you perceive not.* means, "We ordered you to refrain from raising your voices to the Prophet ﷺ, so that he will not get angry with you, because in doing so, you will also anger Allah." The good deeds of he who caused the Prophet's anger will become useless without him even knowing. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith that states, *i* fi 4is2 Wu: l«J JL; N JU; jil ji I* 6*. Wu ijiJ: i \$£ 4.1 iasdu ji^ii Stf iSLyi tuii» js uid jfiii* «Verily, a man might utter a word that pleases Allah the Exalted, even though he does not recognize the significance of his word, and on its account Paradise is written for him. Verily, a man might utter a word carelessly that angers Allah the Exalted, and on its account, he is cast in the Fire farther than the distance between the heavens and earth . |2) Ahmad 3:137. Similar was recorded by Muslim no. 119. 121 Fath Al-B&ri 11:314.

Allah then ordains lowering one's voice before the Messenger and encourages, directs and recommends this better behavior. *il?! }! 4jil j jc. i* Verily, those who lower their voices in the presence of Allah's Messenger, they are the ones whose hearts Allah has tested for Taqwa whose hearts have been purified by Allah and made as a residence and dwelling for the Taqwa, **j\$3 i* For them is forgiveness and a great reward Imam Ahmad recorded in the Book of Az-Zuhd that Mujahid said, "Someone wrote to 'Umar, 'O Leader of the faithful! Who is better, a man who does not feel the desire to commit a sin and does not commit it, or a man who feels desire to commit a sin, but does not commit it?' 'Umar replied, "He who feels desire to commit a sin, but does not commit it, / | . 4*f' t)s • " 5 t, ft S i\ they are the ones whose hearts Allah has tested for Taqwa. For them is forgiveness and a great reward. <£«- i jij 't (v“a£=J fly jt diff jy^/- Hfj j-A iff- rje- 44. Verily, those who call you from behind the dwellings, most of them have no sense 45. And if they had patience till you could come out to them, it would have been better for them. And Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful Admonishing Those Who call the Prophet from behind Dwellings Allah the Exalted and Most Blessed admonished those, such as the uncivilized bedouins, who used to call to the Prophet ﷺ, from behind the dwellings which belong to his wives,

189 Surah 49. Al-Huiurd (6-8) (Part-26) *imost of them have no sense* Allah the Exalted and Most Honored then ordains the better behavior in this regard, *4mJ£ o£j LJi 4* And if they had patience till you could come out to them, it would have been better for them . \$> it would have earned them the better benefit of this life and the Hereafter. Allah, Worthy of all praise, then encourages them to turn to Him in repentance. 4And Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful. It was reported that this Ayah was revealed about Al-Aqra' bin Habis At-Tamimi, may Allah be pleased with him, according to more than one source. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Aqra' bin Habis said that he called the Messenger of Allah ﷺ from behind his dwellings, saying, "O Muhammad! O Muhammad!" "O Allah's Messenger!" according to another narration, but the Messenger ﷺ did not answer him, Al-Aqra' said, "O Allah's Messenger. My praise (of others) is worthwhile and my admonishment (of others) is degrading." The Prophet ﷺ replied, *J*rj> 5l>! iSljn* «It is Allah the Exalted (Who is worthy of this description) L-ji j j yi .-i jL [i-U

be in trouble. But Allah has endeared the faith to you and has beautified it in your hearts, and has made disbelief, Fusuq and 'Isyan hateful to you. Such are they who are the rightly guided. i8. (This is) a grace from Allah and His favor. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} Investigating the Reliability of the News conveyed by Wicked People Allah the Exalted ordered investigating the news that sinners and the wicked bring, to make sure of its authenticity. Otherwise, if the sinner's word is taken for granted and a decision is based on it, regardless of whether the information is true or not, the authorities will be taking the lead of the sinners. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored forbade taking the path of the corrupted and sinners. This is why groups of the scholars of Hadith refuse to accept narrations from narrators whose reliability is unknown, for they might be from among the wicked people, in reality. The Prophet's Decision is Better Allah said, iM ja; 3p%} iAnd know that among you there is the Messenger of Allah.} know that among you is the Messenger of Allah jg. Therefore, honor and respect him, be polite with him and obey his orders. For he is more knowledgeable about what benefits you and is more concerned with you than you yourselves are. His opinions in such matters are more complete than your own.' Allah the Exalted and Most Blessed said in another Ayah, iThe Prophet is closer to the believers than themselves} (33:6). Then He clarifies that they fall short in overseeing their own benefit; ipC&U 4 fr

and Most Honored .» They stood behind him in lines and he said, V) oUJ lj L-t n'3 .i.L'.; uj ^4,1* n
jUiJi iuii iu UJ Vj bi.»o UJ Nj bojju ^Ux« Vj t cJUUsi ^vLJ ^y» Ulip la,.1.1 i UJ JIpIU 1/j tOlIpU UJ
Hj 4 C.,llaP dj>%j V jUUJl ^-^J J JjjLlI ^ill t tjijjj ULUisj «-l1U>-JJ UjISU i_f*! ' fji U-*J (*3*
JjlLlI . Jj)i Nj J. , , - s , /# , 4 J ' ,, ,, j_j j j'V I uJj >M.> ^_gJl . Ul«Jw« U jm! UliPi U jZt ^jA «jjli
JuLp jUluJij 3 > ^iSsii UJj o J>j U^Ji j;li p_^Jl 4 jmL* *Vj lj 1j^>- jS' ^-jkJLuiJL Ui>xJlj Uj-lj 4
wl>JlPj ^Jp fcllllyw J^P jjJUajJ kjJU-j <1>vj&j J^JJl o^J5sJ «jiil iil U-teJl I)ji ^Jl Vj& J;IS j\$Jl «0

Allah! Your is the praise. O Allah! There is none ivho can withhold what You send, or send what You loithhold, or guide ivhom You send astray, or misguide whomever You guide, or give what You deprive, or deprive whom You give, or draw closer whom You cast or cast whom You draw closer. O Allah! Bestow on us from Your blessings, mercy, grace and provisions. O Allah! I ask You for the eternal delight that never ends or fades away. O Allah! I ask You for provisions on the Day of deprivation and safety on the Day offear. O Allah! 1 seek refuge with You from the evil repercussions of what You have given us and from the evil of what You have deprived us of. O Allah! Make faith dear to us and beatify it in our hearts and make disbelief, Fusfiq and Tsyah hateful to us, and make us among tlte rightly guided. O Allah! Allow us to die as Muslims, live as Muslims and join us with the ranks of the righteous ones, without tasting humiliation or turmoil. O Allah! Fight the disbelievers ivlw deny Your Messengers and hinder others from Your path; send on them Your torment and punishment. O Allah! Fight the disbelievers who were given the Scriptures, the True God."'''111 |il Ahmad 3 :424.

193Surah 49. Al-Hujurd (9-10) (Part-26) J mm* on iTV An-Nasal collected s ' •/Vf./ <' * A // S'9' * A "t \ ^n.L . ' .<i^»1 jJ .-.1; Ia^V^O^C-jtljOi'iL-iVj t VLi^i2S[;^3li\!i>J£v;244 this Hadith in 'Amal A l - Ya wm w a l - LaylahJ Allah said, ^iU^j jil Si ydi>^ 4(77ns fsd n grace from Allah and His favor.) meaning, this favor that He has bestowed on you is a favor and a bounty from Him to you, <i£^ %> 4And Allah is All- Knowing, All-Wise.} All-Knower in those who deserve guidance and those who deserve misguidance, All-Wise in His statements, actions, legislation and the destiny He appoints. ojj' jp U< » *»[oJo4 dj-x iyilii ulILU» Jff} C-£ 41*1 ul 1, t ii. o:U jli jjil S', <A? 4 ';Oyl-y ^l«i iil ijijfj C# iyi Oji-ij-l' 7 ~' '«\f./W 49. And if two parties among tire believers fall to fighting, then make peace betzueen them both. But if one of them outrages against the other, then fight you (all) against the one that which outrages till it complies with the command of Allah. Then if it complies, then make reconciliation between them justly, and be equitable. Verily, Allah loves those who are tire equitable.} 410. The believers are but a brotherhood. So make reconciliation m An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :156

194 Tafsir IbtI Kathir between your brothers, and have Taqwd of Allah that you may receive mercy .} Making Peace between Disputing Muslims Allah commands making peace between Muslims that fight each other, bop' S; of)} iAnd if tivo parties among the believers fall to fighting, then make peace between them both .} Therefore, Allah calls both opposing groups among Muslims, believers, although they are fighting each other. Al-Bukhari and other scholars relied on this Hadith as evidence that committing a sin does not nullify faith, no matter how major the sin is. This creed contradicts the creed of the Khawarij sect and those who accepted their idea, such as the Mutazilah sect. Al-Bukhari narrated that Al-Hasan said that Abu Bakrah said that the Messenger of Allah % gave a speech on the Minbar while Al-Hasan bin 'Ali was with him. He was repeatedly looking at Al-Hasan and then at the people; then said, b' 4Jdl IJIA b|® « Verily, this son ofmine is a Sayyid (chiefor master), and may Allah make peace between two great groups ofMuslims through What the Prophet sg said, occurred. Al-Hasan brought peace between the people of Ash-Sham and Iraq, after they fought tremendous wars and frightening battles. Allah's statement, 4PP jil '-Z/i yP b>-Vi £ Ipjp 4But if one of them outrages against the other, then fight you (all) against the one that which outrages till it complies with the command ofAllah.} means, until the rebellious group refers to the commands of Allah and His Messenger for judgement and they listen to and obey the truth. There is a Hadith in the Sahih in which

195 Surah 49. Al-Huiurdt (9-10) (Part-26) Anas states that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, f llJUi «Help your brother, ivhether he is an oppressor or he is oppressed .» “I asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! It is right that I help him if he is oppressed, but how should I help him if he is an oppressor?’ He said, • alii b —‘eu illij ^ <iBy preventing him from oppressing others; this is how you help him in this case. n”,1] Said bin Jubayr said that tribes of Aws and Khazraj once got in a scuffle using date tree branches and slippers. Allah revealed this honorable Ayah commanding them to make peace between them. 121 As-Suddi said, “A man from Al-Ansar, whose name was Imran, had a wife called Umm Zayd. She wanted to visit her family, but her husband prevented her from visiting them by locking her in an upper room. So, none of her family could visit or see her. She sent someone to her family. They came, took her down from the room and wanted to take her away. Her husband was absent at the time, so his family called on their people. Their cousins came to help prevent the wife from going with her family. A push and shove situation occurred that led to them fighting using slippers. This Ayah was then revealed in their case, and the Messenger of Allah sent someone to bring peace between them, and they both agreed to resort to the decision of Allah the Exalted.”131 The statement of Allah the Exalted, next, ivLbtt Lk& k sM; £& \r&^ iThen if it complies, then make reconciliation between them justly, and be equitable. Verily, Allah loves those who are the m Fath Al-Bari 5:118. [a| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7:560. At-Tabari 22 :294 . This and the previous statement fall under the category of those narrations mentioned in the beginning of the book.

equitable.} means, be fair in your judgement regarding the dispute that occurred between them, iVerily, Allah loves those who are the equitable.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded, that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, l>Jl Uj ^ p I. ' HrImJ_U 1 .fcoApi i «dliij ^Verily, those who are equitable in this life, will be on podiums made of pearls before Ar-Rahmdn, the Exalted and Most Honored, on account of their fairness in this lifaj An-NasaT collected this Hadith . [1 ' Allah’s statement, 4’h Ci) iThe believers are but a brotherhood.} means, all of them are brothers in Islam. The Messenger of Allah% said, «77ie Muslim is the brother of the Muslim, he is not unjust with him nor does he forsake / lim.®*21 In the Sahih, Oy jJl oiS" IS JJJ! Oy. 4ll «Allah helps the servant as long as the servant helps his brother. n [31 Also in the Sahih: Jij jjjl :ciLji jii 5-af-S/ «ji us isi® "1/ f/ie Muslim invokes Allah for the benefit of his absent brother, the angel says afterwards, "Amin, and far you the same."vW An-NasaT in Al-Kubra 5917. 121 Fath Al-Bari 5:116. Muslim 4:2074. Muslim 4 :2094

197 Surah 49. Al-Huiurat (11) (Part-26) There are many Hadiths with this meaning, such as, in the Sahih, 1i| J—>Jl JilS ,4r\7e\yj yj J ^ * * Ij ^aXilLt .jLl. ^pljj yjl£. iThe parable of the believers in relation to the kindness, mercy and compassion they have for each other, is that of the body : when an organ of it falls ill, the rest of the body responds zwith fever and sleeplessness." 1 11 And also in Sahih. gl^aju JLij “A believer to another believer is like a building whose different parts enforce each other. The Prophet then clasped his hands with the fingers interlaced.121 Allah’s statement, <So make reconciliation between your brothers,} refers to the two groups that fight each other, iand have Taqwa ofAllah} in all ofyour affairs, i’oyy ithat you may receive mercy.} and this is a promise from Allah that He will grant mercy to those who fear and obey Him. &-* zk fri !<*- 2s-* /j (j A-i V lyA* cA \$k} m &A %&& &S v;& ill. O you who believe! Let not a group scoff at another group, it may be that the latter are better than tireformer. Nor let (some) women scoffat other women, it may be that the latter are better than the former. Nor defame yourselves, nor insult 111 Muslim 4:1999. 121 Fath Al-Bari 5:119.

one another by nicknames. Evil is the name of wickedness after faith. And whosoever does not repent, then such are indeed wrongdoers. The Prohibition of mocking and ridiculing One Another Allah the Exalted forbids scoffing at people, which implies humiliating and belittling them. In the Sahih, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{«Arrogance is refusing the truth and belittling people. And in another Version Lili.» «And despising people»}$ It is forbidden to scoff at and belittle people, for the injured party could be more honored and dearer to Allah the Exalted than those who ridicule and belittle them. This is why Allah the Exalted said. $\text{k-6 «if you who believe! Let not a group scoff at another group, it may be that the latter are better than the former. Nor let (some) women scoff at other women, it may be that the latter are better than the former. thus, stating this prohibition for men and then women. The statement of Allah the Exalted, «Nor defame yourselves,» forbids defaming each other. He among men who is a slanderer, and a backbiter, is cursed and condemned as Allah states «Woe to every Humazah, Lumazah»(104:1) Hamz is defamation by m Muslim 1 :93}$

199 Surah 49. Al-Hujurat (11) (Part-26) action, while Lamz is by words. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, $\text{«Hamaz (defaming), going about with slander.»}$ (68:11) meaning, he belittles and defames people, transgressing and spreading slander among them, which is the Lamz that uses words as its tool. Allah's statement here, $\text{«Nor defame yourselves, just as He said in another Ayah, «Nor kill yourselves» (4:29), meaning, nor kill one another. 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said that the Ayah, «Nor defame yourselves,» means, none of you should defame each other,' while, «nor insult one another by nicknames.» means, «you should not address people by nick names that people dislike.' Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Jabr bin Ad-Dahhak said, «This Ayah was revealed about us, Banu Salamah; «» nor insult one another by nicknames. When the Messenger of Allah migrated to Al-Madina, every man among us had two or three nicknames. When the Prophet ﷺ called a man by one of these nicknames, people would say, 'O Allah's Messenger! He hates that nickname.' Then this Ayah, «» nor insult one another by nicknames.» was revealed.» Abu 111 Ahmad 4 :460.}$

Dawud also collected this Hadith. [i] The statement of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored, $\text{«Evil is the name of wickedness after faiths, means, the names and descriptions of wickedness are evil; meaning, 'to use the nicknames that were used by the people of Juhiliyyah, after you embraced Islam and understood it,' 43 «And whosoever does not repent,» means, from this sin, then such are indeed wrongdoers.} Vj «if you who believe! Avoid much suspicion; indeed some suspicion is sin. And spy not, neither backbite one another. Would one of you like to eat the flesh of his dead brother? You would hate it. And have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance, Most Merciful.» The Prohibition of Unfounded Suspicion Allah the Exalted forbids His faithful servants from being suspicious, which includes having doubts and suspicions about the conduct of one's family, relatives and other people in general. Therefore, Muslims are to avoid suspicion without foundation. The Leader of the faithful 'Umar bin Al-Khattab said, «Never think ill of the word that comes out of your believing brother's mouth, as long as you can find a good excuse for it.»»21 Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said, Abu Dawud 5:246. Az-Zuhd by Imam Ahmad , Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :99}$

zd\y-\ ij 4-iji jkLl Sii ^! 4)1 IjjjS i \jji\j5 j Ij.iApLj Y ^Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the worst of false tales; do not spy on one another; do not look for other's faults; do not be jealous of one another; do not envy one another; do not hate one another; and do not desert (shun) one another. And O Allah's servants! Be brothers!^ The Two Sahihs and Abu Dawud recorded this Hadith. (21 Anas said that the Messenger of Allah *sg* said, > > „ Yj it IyjSj Tj Yj \ffx, Yj l\li" d'% JU-13^ M OliJ J*J «Do not shun each other; do not ignore one another; do not hate one another, and do not envy one another, and be brothers, O servants of Allah. No Muslim is allowed to shun his brother for more than three days.» Muslim and At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith, who considered it SahihP* Allah said, 4And spy not}, on each other. Tajassus, usually harbors ill intentions, and the spy is called a Jasus. As for Tahassus (inquiring) it is usually done for a good reason. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said that Prophet Ya'qub said, 4.\$ c>i Yj JLiJj 0; iE>si 1^.) 4“O my sons! Go you and inquire (Tahassasu) about Yusuf and his brother, and never give up hope of Allah's mercy.”} (12:87) Both of these terms, ‘Tajassus’ and Tahassus ' could have evil connotations. In the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah *sg* said, 4>l SU lfjS'j r, i'j ij \j2JSd Y» 111 Al-Muwatta'2 :907 121 Fath Al-Bari 10:499. 131 Muslim 4 :1983 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :46

“Neither commit Tajassus nor Tahassus nor hate each other nor commit Tadabur. And be brothers, O servants of Allah, n111 Al-Awzat said, “Tajassus means, to search for something, while Tahassus means, listening to people when they are talking without their permission, or eavesdropping at their doors. Tadabur refers to shunning each other.” Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement. Allah the Exalted said about backbiting; fe ^ %) in neither backbite one another), thus prohibiting it, which was explained in a Hadith collected by Abu Dawud that Abu Hurayrah said, “It was asked, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! What is backbiting?’ He said, ujz LL> duf hjs’it “Mentioning about your brother in a manner that he dislikes .» He was asked, What if my brother was as I mentioned?’ He jg said, Jji Jy& U jL_j i«d\l Jii J_jij li 4J j\£ j|t «// he was as you mentioned, you will have committed backbiting. But if he was not as you say about him, you will have falsely accused him. At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith and said “Hasan Sahih.”^ Backbiting was sternly warned against, and this is why Allah the Exalted and Most Blessed compared it to eating the flesh of a dead human being, C aJPjM d 10) iWould one of you like to eat the flesh of his dead brother? You would hate it.) Just as you hate eating the flesh of a dead person, on account of your nature; so hate backbiting, on account of your religion. The latter carries a punishment that is worse than the former. This Ayah seeks to discourage people from backbiting and Fath Al-Bari 10:496. Abu Dawud 5:191. Muslim no . 2589 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :63

203 Surah 49. Al-Hujurd (12) (Part-26) warns against it. The Prophet *sg* used these words to discourage taking back a gift that one gives to someone, (fry. p aHe is just like the dog that eats its vomitJ after saying, »Oi<rs is not an evil parableV Using various chains of narration, the Sahihs and Musnads record that the Prophet jg said during the Farewell Hajj: f'y - j!, «lli j I Ilk ‘Verily, your blood, wealth and honor are as sacred among you as the sanctity of this day of yours, in this month of yours, in this town of yours. »|21 Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah 3^5 said, jl 'Jh\ oi *j£j* 1 <LOj A-0 ^ f: “All of the Muslim is sacred to the Muslim, his wealth, honor and his blood. It is evil enough for someone to belittle his Muslim brother.»*31 At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith and said “Hasan Gharib.”*41 Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that a cousin of Abu Hurayrah said, “Ma’iz came to the Messenger of Allah jg and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! I have committed adultery,’

and the Messenger jg turned away from him until Ma'iz repeated his statement four times. The fifth time, the Prophet jg asked him, «^5» 111 FathAl-B&ri 5:278. ,2) Fath Al-B&ri 3 :670 , Muslim 3:1306, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :481 and Ahmad 1 :230 ' Abu Dawud 5:195. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :54

"Have you committed adultery?» Ma'iz said, 'Yes.' The Prophet asked, •VjjJI U "Do you knmu xvhat adultery means?* Ma'iz said, 'Yes. I have illegally done with her what a husband legally does with his wife.'The Prophet said, iJU Jj 1J u» 'What do you seek to accomplish by this statement?i Ma'iz said, 1 intend thatyou purify me.'The Prophet asked, ^ 3 aUJLJI '-rr^i^ 44 4lJj Ji4 dlli cJU-jU "Have you gone into her just as the stick goes into the kohl container and the rope goes into the well? Ma'iz said, "Yes, O Allah's Messenger!' The Prophet jg commanded that Ma'iz be stoned to death and his order was carried out. The Prophet heard two men saying to one another, 'Have you not seen the man who had Allah cover his secret, but his heart could not let him rest until he was stoned to death, just as the dog is stoned?' The Prophet gfe continued on and when he passed by the corpse of a donkey, he asked, "Where are so-and-so? Dismount and eatfrom this donkey. They said, 'May Allah forgive you, O Allah's Messenger! Would anyone eat this meat?' The Prophet jg said; j i Lajl USL>-I ULzlj «4j <jj\ 8The backbiting you committed against your brother is worse as a meal than this meal. By He in Wlwse Hand is my soul! He is now swimming in the rivers of Paradise.*" This Hadith has an authentic chain of narrationJ Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin 'Abdullah said, "We Musnad Abu Ya'la 6:524, similar was recorded by Abu Dawud, no.

205Surah 49. Al-Hujurat (13) (Part-26) were with the Messenger of Allah jg when a rotten odor was carried by the wind. The Messenger of Allah said, j sJLa oJla 13 "Do you know what this odor is? It is the odor of those who backbite people Accepted Repentance from Backbiting and Slander Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, <sS1 iAnd have Taqzva of Allah}, that is, regarding what He has commanded you and forbidden for you. Fear Him and beware of Him, ^3 ^>y iVerily, Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance, Most Merciful.} He forgives those who repent to Him, is merciful with those who go back to Him and trust in Him. The majority of scholars have stated that repentance for committing the sin of backbiting is that one refrains from backbiting intending not to repeat it again. There is a difference of opinion if whether feeling remorse is required in this case, and also if one should apologize to those who he has backbitten. Some scholars stated that it is not necessary for one to ask those whom he has backbitten to forgive him, because if they knew what was said about them, they could be hurt more than if they were not told about it. It is better, they said, that one should preuse those whom he has backbitten in audiences in which he has committed the act. It is also better if one defends the injured party against any further backbiting, as much as one can, as recompense for his earlier backbiting. 9 " - / ' AX>\ 111 Ahmad 3:351

413. O mankind! We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into nations and tribes that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable ofyou with Allah is that (believer) who has At-Taqwa. Verily, Allah is All- Knowing, All-Aware.) All ofMankind are the Children of 'Adam and Hawwa' Allah the Exalted declares to mankind that He has created them all from a single person, 'Adam, and from that person He created his mate, Hawwa'. From their offspring He made nations, comprised of tribe, which include subtribes of all sizes. It was also said that 'nations refers to non-Arabs, while 'tribes refers to Arabs. Various statements about this were collected in an individual

introduction from the book, *Al-Inbah*, by Abu 'Amr Ibn 'Abdul-Barr, and from the book, *Al-Qasad wal-Amam fi Ma'rifah Ansab Al-Arab wal-'Ajam*. Therefore, all people are the descendants of 'Adam and Hawwa' and share this honor equally. The only difference between them is in the religion that revolves around their obedience to Allah the Exalted and their following of His Messenger *sg*. After He forbade backbiting and belittling other people, alerting mankind that they are all equal in their humanity. Allah said, 40 mankind! We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into nations and tribes that you may know one another. so that they get to know each other by their nation or tribe. Mujahid said that Allah's statement. *ithat you may know one another* refers to one's saying, "So-and- so the son of so-and-so, from the tribe ofso-and-so." 111 Sufyan Ath-Thawri said, "The Himyar (who resided in Yemen) dealt with each other according to their provinces, while the Arabs in the Hijaz (Western Arabia) dealt with each other according to their tribes." At-Jabari 22:312.

207 Surah 49. *Al-Huiurat* (13) (Part-26) Honor is earned through Taqwa of Allah Allah the Exalted said, *jit i* Verily, the most honorable of you with Allah is that (believer) who has At-Taqwa meaning, "you earn honor with Allah the Exalted on account of Taqwa, not family lineage." There are many Hadiths from the Prophet *fg* that support this meaning. Al-Bukhari narrated that Abu Hurayrah said, "Some people asked the Prophet *fg*, Who is the most honorable among people?" He replied, «The most honorable among them with Allah is the one who has the most Taqwa. They said, We did not ask you about this.' He said, «*il Jt\ 4)1 y) i4) ' y} Jr' 01 f'jfa* "Then the most honorable person is Yusuf, Allah's Prophet, the son of Allah's Prophet, the son of Allah's Prophet, the son of Allah's Khalilj They said, We did not ask you about this.' He said, . *>'y>C I jllii y^* «Then you want to ask me about the Arab lineage? * They said, *Yes.' He said, *u* Those among you who were best in Jahiliyyah, are the best among you in Islam, if they attain religious understanding. Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith in several places of his *Sahih*, [2] An-Nasab did as well in the Tafsir section of his *Sunan*. 131 Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah *fg* said, *Ji >L;^3 'fbrfj J! 'M ^ k 111 Fath. Al-B&ri :8 :212 121 Fath Al-Bari 6 :477 and 481 ' An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :367*

« Verily , Allah does not look at your shapes or wealth, but he looks at your hearts and actions. Ibn Majah also collected this HadithP Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "On the day Makkah was conquered, the Messenger of Allah *fg* performed Tawaf around the Kabah while riding his camel, Al-Qaswa', and was touching the corners with a stick he had in his hand. He did not find a place in the Masjid where his camel could sit and had to dismount on men's hands. He led his camel to the bottom of the valley, where he had her sit down. The Messenger of Allah later gave a speech while riding Al-Qaswa' and said, after thanking Allah the Exalted and praising Him as He should be praised. *t tfSljlj £1aUJ| Ji JjiLi; 2il jl •j* 2>' (i-ij> 'j> <1*45 j* u* J-& :JjZ 'fa 2)1 jl 2il •4!'^£# k^& i* "Z'M k &&* "O people! Allah the Exalted has removed from you the slogans of Jahiliyyah and its tradition of honoring forefathers . Men are of two types, a man who is righteous, fearful of Allah and honorable to Allah, or a man who is vicious, miserable and little to Allah the Exalted. Verily, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 40 mankind! We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into nations and tribes, that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable of you with Allah is that (believer) who has At-Taqwa. Verily, Allah is All- Knowing, All-Aware

The Prophet said, fa 2)1 liJ. fay JyU »/ say this and invoke AllahforforgivenessfarmeandfaryouX' This was recorded by 'Abd bin Humayd.131 Allah the Exalted said, Muslim 4:1987. Ibn Majah 2:1388. Al-Muntakhab by 'Abd bin Humayd 793

J- tim eW 'o5^ S& 'bt&f [rtr*r'[£- ' *H ' ift'ls S\J> illol.il' y&JifJSjtsilili J^=>t tPb (fV il'o){50-i^il^Ct j£=J\jijlldJjLijCycet. J —ijj JilI*'k_j' c/^'cJ li <sj? <i£. >r y-yj 'vilo\$-£S\Cl[(*-*dlliJjidi' }{* *A^ C* / > • "•* *_* - > _^» + ^-=SL^>Jj<xu\s^j J*M y ' Jji^Zatt >-jf- 'ilbUf_/J '(4^_>^o -» . J'tjU^jJu ii'i^ Elp j^Li^i^u>J4ifjoj»^VL>ij 4X-f- t~&- il' 4Verily, Allah is All- Knowing, All-Aware.} means, 'He is All- Knowing of you and All-Aware of all ofyour affairs.' Allah guides whom He wills, misguides whom He wills, grants mercy to whom He wills, tor- ments whom He wills, elevateswhom He wills above whom He wills. He is the All-Wise, the All-Knowing, the All- Aware in all this. Several scholars relied on this honorable Ayah and the honora- ble Hadiths we menti- oned as evidence that compatibility in marriagem is not a condition of marriage contracts. They said that the only condition required in this regard is the adherence to the religion, as in the statement of Allah, the Exalted, f)S Xt ^ji=>»1 4Verily, the most honorable of you with Allah is the one with the most Taqwa.} 0>J 4 J3j \fj? ^ ji h: Jti> i>J' Cj>1 j .^>y jyi- <i' o», bli j* fIXi 'i ii' (*j> oliij' jit Jc^ 4 > <t“ 'j i£t5^ Jj |*j -*LAI> c.*lh •- i-"" . f?<\ • i" »k ,i* ' T? ' l| V*J j-*) « c| 1* pJ->» 4U'J p.==Cj <0>1 O^oul ^Ajj IM With regards to social status, wealth, family lineage, etc.

i jfc&a #gS tfi fcfcJ y J& \$\$\$££ tJ- \$i , - <> - t'-u c .4:f' *•< ,.- «, <*, ' ^ • •t'— U*_) 4il'j ojt/jl) ^Iaj aA' ,W _ ^y^J-Xh 414. The bedouins say: 'We believe." Say: "You do not believe. But say, We have submitted,' for Faith has not yet entered your hearts. But ifyou obey Allah and His Messenger, He zuill not decrease anything in rewardfor your deeds. Verily, Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful."} 415. Only those are the believers who have believed in Allah and His Messenger, and afterward doubt not but strive with their wealth and their lives for the cause of Allah. Tlwse! They are the truthful. 416. Say: "Will you inform Allah ofyour religion while Allah btoivs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and Allah is All-Aware ofeverything."} 417. They regard as a favor to you that they have embraced Islam. Say: "Do not count your Islam as a favor to me. Nay, but Allah has conferred a favor upon you that He has guided you to the Faith ifyou indeed are trite."} 418. "Verily , Allah knows the Unseen of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is the All-Seer ofwhat you do."} There is a Difference between a Believer and a Muslim Allah chastises the bedouins who, when they embraced Islam, claimed for themselves the grade of faithful believers. However, Faith had not yet firmly entered their hearts, 4%Ja 4 &&GU ^ jS J fee 4The bedouins say: 'We believe." Say: "You do not believe, but say, We have submitted,' for Faith has not yet entered your hearts..."} This honorable Ayah, provides proof that Faith is a higher grade than Islam, according to the scholars of the Ahl us- Sunnah wal-Jam&'ah. This is also demonstrated in the HadXth of Jibril, peace be upon him, when he questioned the Prophet Sg about Islam, then Iman then Ihsan. Thus moving the

211Surah 49. Al-Hujurdt (14-18) Part-26 general matter to one more specific, then even more specific. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amir bin Sa'd bin Abi Waqqas said, "The Messenger of Allah jg gave (something to) some men and did not give one of them. Sa'd said, 'O Allah's Messenger, you gave to so-and-so and so-and-so. However, you gave nothing to so-and-so, even though he is a believer.' The Prophet sg said, «Or say, a Muslim .» Sa'd repeated his statement thrice each time the Prophet 3g

answered, "Or say, a Muslim .» The Prophet sg then said, $\text{ijiSj h} \backslash \text{iiiJ} \wedge \text{i}) \backslash \text{Jl} \gg \ll /$ might give some men and give nothing to others, even though the latter are dearer to me than the former. I do not give them things for fear that they might be thrown on their faces in the Fire.®" This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahibs.¹²¹ Therefore, the Prophet 2g made a distinction between the grade of believer and the grade of Muslim, indicating that Iman is a more exclusive grade than Islam. I mentioned this subject in detail supported by evidence, in the beginning of the explanation of the chapter on Iman in Sahih Al-Bukhari, all praise is due to Allah and all the favors are from Him. So this proves that the bedouins whom the Ayah mentioned were not hypocrites, rather they were Muslims in whose hearts Faith was not yet firmly established. They claimed a higher grade for themselves than the grade that they earned, and they were taught a lesson as a consequence. This meaning agrees with the meaning given by Ibn 'Abbas, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Qatadah and that preferred by Ibn Jarir. These 111 Ahmad 1:176. ¹²¹ FathAl-Bari 1 :99, Muslim 1:132.

bedouins were taught a lesson, $\text{f, +} \wedge \text{x i} _ \gg > \text{i} \bullet \ast \}$ «f3V?i/: "You do not believe, but say 'We are Muslims,' for Faith has not yet entered your hearts..."} meaning, You have not yet achieved the reality of Faith.' Allah the Exalted said, $\text{Li}\&\&\text{! fez} \& \backslash \text{f4 jf} > \}$ iBut if you obey Allah and His Messenger, He will not decrease anything in reward for your deeds.. .} 'He will not decrease any of your rewards,' as Allah said; $\text{Z jfe} \ast \text{Z Zj} \}$ iWe shall not decrease the reward of their deeds in anything (52 :21) Allah said: $\text{iL4}\&\$ \wedge \text{4}$ Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} for those who repent and return to Him. Allah's statement, iOnly those are the believers}, who have perfect Faith, 'tf (A 'Ay-Jj AL jZ iivho have believed in Allah and His Messenger, and afterward doubt not} They do not have doubts and their Faith was not shaken. Rather, their Faith remained on conviction, iBut strive for the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives} meaning, they gladly gave away their life and the most precious of their wealth in obedience to Allah as a means of seeking His pleasure,

4Those! They are the truthful. 'in their statement if they say that they are believers, unlike some bedouins who are faithful only by words outwardly!' Allah said, 4Say: "Will you inform Allah of your religion..." "will you inform Allah of what is in your hearts,' iivhile Allah knows all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth,) Nothing in the heavens and earth, even the weight of a speck of dust, all that is bigger or smaller, ever escapes His observation, iand Allah is All-Aware of everything.) Allah said, $\wedge \text{4i} \text{-J sjz} \}$ 4They regard as a favor to you that they have embraced Islam Say: "Do not count your Islam as a favor to me..." meaning the bedouins who considered embracing Islam, following and supporting the Messenger $\wedge$ as a favor to him. Allah the Exalted refuted their false statement, $\text{£ l}\&\text{S}$ 4 iSay: "Do not count your Islam as a favor to me..." for the benefit of your Islam will only be yours, and this is a favor from Allah to you,' 4Nay, but Allah has conferred a favor upon you that He has guided you to the Faith if you indeed are true.) 'in your claim that you are believers.' The Prophet said to the Ansar on the day of the battle of Hunayn, iii (liuju 'pzSj $\text{v} \wedge \text{ii jji} \text{!juJV i U}$ "

²¹⁴ Tafslr Ibn Kathir «O Ansar! Have I not found you astray and Allah guided you through me? Were you not divided and Allah united you around me? Were you not poor and Allah gave you riches through me? Whenever the Prophet jg asked them any of these questions, they would reply, "Allah and His Messenger have most favored us." Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Banu Asad came to the Messenger of Allah gg and said, 'O Allah's Messenger! We embraced Islam, and

before that, the Arabs fought against you, yet we did not fight against you.' The Messenger of Allah said, «Verily, they understand but little and the Shaytan speaks through their words. This Ayah was later revealed, iThey regard as a favor to you that they have embraced Islam. Say: "Do not count your Islam as a favor to me." Nay, but Allah has conferred a favor upon you that He has guided you to the Faith if you indeed are true."}*2 Then Allah reminds that He has complete knowledge of all creations and that He sees them all; Lj ofSt \j C^j- ^Lu &! {Verily, Allah knows the Unseen of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is the All-Seer of what you do.} This is the end of the Tafslr of Surat Al-Hujurat. Verily, all praise is due to Allah, all the favors are from Him, and from Him comes the success and protection from error. 111 FathAl-B6ri 7:644. ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 11519.

Surah 50: Qaf

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5499]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Qaf (Chapter - 50)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5499–5511]

The Beginning of the Mufasssal Section of the Qur'an This Surah is the first Surah in the Mufasssal section of the Qur'an, according to the correct view. It is said that the Mufasssal starts with Surat Al-Hujurat. Some common people say that the Mufasssal starts with Surah 'Ammah An-Naba, (chapter 78), however, this is not true because none of the respected scholars ever supported this opinion. Aws (bin Hudhayfah) said; "I asked the Companions of Allah's Messenger (j&) how they divided the Qur'an. They said; Three, five, seven, nine, eleven, thirteen, and the Mufasssal section as one." This was recorded by Ibn Majah and Imam Ahmad. 121 If one counts forty-eight Surahs, the next Surah will be Surah Qaf The details are as follows: The [first] three Surahs are Al-Baqarah (chapter 2), Al-Imran (3), then An-Nisab (4). The five are Al-Ma'idah (5), Al-An'am (6), Al-A'raf (7), Al-Anfal (8) and Bara'ah (or At-Tawbah) (9). The seven next Surahs are Surah Yunus (10), Hud (11), Yusuf (12), Ar-Ra'd (13), Ibrahim (14), Al-Hijr (15) and An-Nahl (16). The nine next Surahs are, Subhan (or Al-Isra' (17)), Al-Kahf (18), Maryam (19), Ta Ha (20), Al-Anbiya' (21), Al-Hajj (22), Al-Mu'minun (23), An-Nur (24) and Al-Furqan (25). The next eleven Surahs are Surat Ash-Shu'ara (26), An-Naml (27), Al-Qasds (28), Al-Ankabut (29), Ar-Rum (30), Luqm&n (31), AlifLam Mim As-Sajdah (32), Al-Ahzab (33), Saba' (34), Fatir (35) and Yd Sin (36). The next thirteen are Surat As-Sajfat (37), Sad (38), Az-Zumar (39), Ghafir (40), I 1 Mufasssal refers here to the short Surahs. This starts from Surah Qaf to the end of the Qur'an Abu Dawud 2:114, Ibn Majah 1 :427 and Ahmad 4:9. This is part of a weak Hadith which was removed

226 Tafsir [bn Kathir Ha Mim As-Sajdah (or Fussilat) (41), Ash-Shura (42), Az-Zukhruf (43), Ad-Dukhan (44), Al-Jathiyah (45), Al-Ahqaf (46), Al-Qital (or Muhammad) (47), Al-Fath (48) and Al-Hujurat (49). After that comes the Mufasssal section, according to the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them all. Therefore, Surah Qaf (chapter 50) is the first of the Mufasssal, just as we stated, and all praise is due to Allah and all favors are from Him. The Virtues of Surah Qaf Imam Ahmad recorded that Tjmar bin Al-Khattab asked Abu Waqid Al-Laythi, "What did the Prophet jg recite during the 'Id Prayer?" Abu Waqid said, " Surah Qaf and Surat Iqtarabat [i.e. Surat Al-Qamar (54)]." Muslim and the Four Collectors of the Sunan collected this HadithJ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Umm Hisham

bint Harithah said, “For around two years, or a year and a part of another year, our oven and the oven of the Prophet ﷺ was one and the same. I memorized Surah, iQaf. By the Glorious Qur'an.} from the tongue of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who used to recite it every Friday while standing on the Minbar delivering the Friday sermon to the people.’ Muslim collected this Hadith. Abu Dawud also recorded that the daughter of Al-Harith bin An-Nu‘man said, “I only memorized Surah Qaff from the mouth of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who used to recite it in every Friday Khutbah. Our oven and the oven of the Messenger ﷺ was one and the same.”¹⁴¹ Muslim and An-Nasab collected this Hadith. Therefore, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to recite this Surah during large gatherings such as the ‘Ids and during Ahmad 5:217, Muslim 2:607, Abu Dawud 1:683, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi, An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 3 :79, 3 : 183 and Ibn Majah 1 :408. ^ Ahmad 6 :435. [31 Muslim 2:595. Abu Dawud 1 :660 Muslim 2 :595, An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 3 :107.

227 Surah 50. Oaf (1-5) (Part-26 / $\epsilon_{in} > ^\wedge t \wedge A \wedge ia KBPP x$: tiliiii?L life grLr*. Ji_4>. <£'jjfe&s\j& 0 U>Uj (pgi-fJ Q&>\) &n\u£&j0^4 0j*-\)Of-j_}&_}@ JyHj \ffeAjjg p>>^ii Cp j>*,3; £p j7- g JL<i CJ j>ji ItflT j 'Jili Friday sermons. He did so because this Surah contains news of the beginning of creation, Resurrection, the Return, Standing (before Allah), the Reckoning, Paradise, the Fire, Allah's reward and punishment, lessons of encouragement, and lessons of discouragement. Allah knows best. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. S. IJ/'mP' i/C\$> — • »•• » J > rx • VI JU* O* 'j/r kJ »(y '-Ca Ij'll^ Cj; lli. iripj Jov'i^ n q; z -iJV 41. Q</. By the Glorious Qur'an.} 42. Nay, they wonder that there has come to them a warner from among themselves. So the disbelievers say: “This is a strange thing!”} 43. “Alatfien we are dead and have become dust. (Shall we be resurrected?) Tlmt is a far return.”} 44. We know that which the earth takes of them, and with Us is a Book preserved.} 45. Nay, but they have denied the truth when it has come to them, so they are in a Marij state.}

iQdf-} which is one of the letters of the alphabet that are mentioned in the beginning of some Surahs, such as, 4Sdd.} (38:1) ill iNun> (68:1) iAlifLam Mini.} (2:1), 4CPr-^ 4Ha Mitn.} (40:1), and i^ 4Ta Sin} (28:1) and etc., Mujahid and several others said this. We also discussed this in the beginning of the explanation of Surat Al-Baqarah, and therefore, it is not necessary to repeat it here. The Disbelievers wonder at the Message and Resurrection Allah said, 4By the Glorious Qur'an.} means by the Honorable and Great Qur'an, which, & ^>jf> .*& ir, Vj it'A c* oi i-zk 4Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it: (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.}(41:42) The subject of the oath contained in this Ayah is specified afterwards, even though it does not appear by word, emphasizing prophethood, resurrection and affirming that they are true. There are similar kinds of oaths in the Qur'an, whose subject is included in the meaning but not by word, such as,

jtlj X/. j LIX S. iSad. By the Qur'an full of reminding. Nay, those who disbelieve are in false pride and opposition .4(38: 1 -2) Allah said here, Jlii ^4-i ^rc o 1 fyi j< ~>r iQdf. By the Glorious Qur'an. Nay, they wonder that there has come to them a warner from among themselves. So the disbelievers say : “This is a strange thing!”} They wondered at the wisdom behind sending a Messenger who is a human being. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said in another Ayah 4o'® J fr-j cH ol Ul»» ils it a wonder for mankind that We have setit Our revelation to a man from among themselves (saying) : “Warn mankind.”} (10:2), meaning, this is not strange, for Allah chooses Messengers from angels and humans. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored mentioned that the disbelievers also wondered about the

Resurrection and discounted its coming, 4\$^ & C0% £ iWhen we are dead and have become dust. That is a far return .> They said, ‘after we die, disintegrate, with our organs tom apart and we become dust, how can we be brought back to our original shape and bodies,’ 4^& iThat is a far return ‘it is not likely that it will ever occur.’ They thought that Resurrection was far from happening and will never occur. Allah the Exalted responded to their statement by saying,

A -V -yx • , A -J - J JiJ'j * v»j ‘H b-'-l jti ^ fcLy UZ»-j jCjJ liJj 46. Have they not looked at the heaven above them, how We have made it and adorned it, and there are no Furfij in it?} 47. And the earth! We have spread it out, and set thereon Raivasi standingfirm, and We planted in it every lovely (Bahij) pair.} 48. An insight and a Reminderfor every servant who turns to Allah in repentance.} 49. And We send down blessed ivater (rain)from the sky, then We produce therewith Janndt and grain that are reaped.} 410. And date palms Basiqat, with arranged clusters.} 411. A provision for the servants. And We give life therewith to a dead land. Thus will be the Resurrection.} Allah's Power and Ability over what is Greater than Resurrection Allah the Exalted notifies the servants of His infinite power, which He demonstrated by creating what is bigger than that which they wondered about and whose possibility they discount, WS '-iff S-vj iH!' j't i#} 4Have they not looked at the heaven above them, hcno We have made it and adorned it,} with lamps; ip) ot & 4and there are no Furij in it?} i.e., clefts, according to Mujahid.l 11 Others said that Furuj means, rifts, or cracks. All these meanings are close to one another. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, Ji tij j* gal* yj^ Ji tSj & yi*-* g- jij Isgti. g3' f m At-Tabari 22 :332

222 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4Who ha? created the seven heavens one above another; you can see no fault in the creation of the Most Gracious. Then look again: “Can you see any rifts?” Then look again and yet again, your sight will return to you in a state ofhumiliation and worn out.} (67:2-4) fatigued, unable to discover any imperfection or shortcomings. The statement of Allah the Exalted, the Blessed, 4^^ iAnd the earth! We have spread it out,} means, *We made it spacious and spread it out,’ iand set thereon Rawdsi standing firm.} which are the mountains to save the earth from shaking along with its inhabitants, gp <jT £< fe iand We planted in it every lovely (BahTj) pair.} every kind and species of plant, fruit and vegetation, iAnd of everything We have created pairs that you may reflect.}(51:49) Allah’s saying ‘Bahij’, meaning a beautiful scene, ;M- i ZfJ'b •stfr 4An insight and a Reminder for every servant who turns to Allah in repentance.} Allah says that observing the creation of the heavens and earth and all the great things that He has placed in them provides insight, proof and a lesson for every penitent servant who submits in humbleness and repentance to Allah feeling fear, in awe of Him. Allah the Exalted said. iAnd We send down blessed water from the sky,} meaning beneficial,

223Surah 50. Oaf (6-11) (Part-26 ithen Wc produce therewith Janndt}, means special and public parks, gardens, etc. iand grain that are reaped£ grains that are harvested for food and for storage for later use, 4And date palms Basiqat,} meaning, tall and high, according to the explanation reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi.11 * Allah said, iij, g: iwith arranged clusters.} producing fruits arranged in clusters, 4iQ. &} 4A provision for (Allah's) servants .} for (Allah’s) creation, iU U. &} 4And We give life therewith to a dead land.} this is the land that was barren. However, when rain falls upon it, it is stirred to life; it swells and produces all of the lovely pairs such as flowers and the like - amazing on account of their beauty. All of this comes into existence

after the land was without greenery, yet it was stirred back to life and became green. Indeed, this should provide proof of Resurrection after death and disintegration; thus Allah resurrects the dead. This sign of Allah's ability that is seen and witnessed is greater than the denial of those who discount the possibility of Resurrection. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said in other Ayat, fiL iz \$*1} }The creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind;} (40:57), Sf"- & & pb cej3\j 4 ,y* — jyj hi At-Tabari 22 :335

224 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iDo they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is Able to do all things.^(46:33) and, Csjjf ol OLO JUft QJ ISji 4A«rf among His signs (is this), that you see the earth barren; but when We send down water to it, it is stirred to life and growth . Verily, He Who gives it life, surely is able to give life to the dead. Indeed He is Able to do all things.\$[41:39) ip&s, jif f? <\$- l* J > J? JjVf fA> / yS? 9v 422. Denied before them the people of Nuh, and the Dwellers of Rass, and Thamiid,\$ 413. And 'Ad, and Fir'awn, and the brethren of Lilt, il4. And the Dwellers of Al-Aykah, and the people of Tiibba' Everyone of them denied (their) Messengers, so My threat took effect. 415. Were We then tired with the first creation? Nay, they are in confused doubt about a new creation. Reminding the Quraysh of the Destruction of earlier Disbelieving Nations Allah the Exalted warns the disbelievers of Quraysh and reminds them of the punishment and painful torment that He sent in this life on their likes, who disbelieved before them. For instance, Allah the Exalted punished the people of Nuh by drowning them in the encompassing flood that touched all the people of earth. There is also the end that struck the people of Ar-Rass, and we mentioned their story before in Surat Al- FurqanJ 1 ' l 1 * See volume seven, the Tafslr of Surat Al-Furqan (25 :38)

4...and Thamud, and 'Ad, and Fir'awn, and the brethren of Lut,} the people of Sadum (Sodom) and the surrounding areas, to whom Lut was sent. Allah the Exalted shook the earth beneath them and turned their area into a reeking lake, as stinking as the disbelief, tyranny and defiance of the Truth that they had, 4And the Dwellers of Al-Aykah}, they are the nation of Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, 4and the people of Tubba'}, King of Yemen; we explained his story in the Tafsir of Surat Ad-Dukhan, !11 and therefore, we do not need to repeat it here. All praise is due to Allah. 4Everyone of them denied (their) Messengers,} means, all of these nations and their generations belied their respective Messenger, and whoever denies even one Messenger, is as if he has denied all Messengers. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, j>jic\$} 4The people of Null denied the Messengers .}(26:105) even though only one Messenger was sent to them, and indeed, if all the Messengers were sent to them, they would have disbelieved in them as well. Allah said, '&} iso My threat took effect.} meaning, the promise of torment and punishment that Allah delivered to them on account of their denial took effect. Therefore, all those who fear suffering the same end should be warned, especially since the latter have denied their Messenger, just as the former denied their Messen- ger. See volume eight , the Tafsir of Surat Ad-Dukhan (44 :37]

Repeating the Creation is Easier than originating It Allah the Exalted said, 4jjVf gj'i iWere We then tired with the first creation? ^ meaning, 'did starting the creation bring fatigue to Us, so as to cause doubt in them that repeating the creation was not possible?' ijt+r H oJ 4 > J# 4Nay, they are in confused doubt about a new creation. meaning, 'starting the creation did not tire Us, and repeating it is even

easier.' Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4And He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him>(30:27), and, LsJ' 'rrf: j* -a—jj Cfy iA G 4And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say : "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All- Knower of every creation!"}(36:78-79) We mentioned earlier a Hadith collected in the Sahih, jUjl Jj? {j-Jj fi' oi' ijrjy. ^ '***' JjZ "Allah the Exalted said, "So/i of 'Adam insults Me when he says, 'He will not resurrect me as He created me before!' But surely, originating creation is not easier for Me than reproducing it again. "i ' 11 'rtf lAj f—Xt ** l* j&j Liu. •fiL iZ***.j ^ -Jy' ^3 V> Jy 1*\$L U ,.w s jiu' OwJl ^ 111 PathAl-Bari 8 :61 1

Sarah 50. Oaf(16-22) (Part-261 227 Olit-j £3 &tfe& i3S&« Ai~* •* ^ . <» ^ *1 ,. t* S' u Xs .s". cij J— ij . T' , _ (<* _ ^J^A— 426. And indeed We have created man, and We know what his self whispers to him. And We are nearer to him than his jugular vein.} \$17. (Remember) that the two receivers (recording angels) receive (each human being), one sitting on the vgh (and one on the left.} 428. Not a word does he (or she) utter but there is a watcher by him ready (to record it).} 429. And the stupor of death will come in truth: "This is what you have been avoiding!"} 420. And the Trumpet will be blown - that will be the Day of the threat.} 422 . And every person will come forth along with a Sd'iq and a Shahid.} 422. (It will be said to the sinners): "Indeed you were heedless of this. Notv We have removed from you, your covering, and sharp is your sight this Day!"} Allah encompasses and watches all of Man's Activity Allah the Exalted affirms His absolute dominance over mankind, being their Creator and the Knower of everything about them. Allah the Exalted has complete knowledge of all thoughts that cross the mind of man, be they good or evil. In the Sahih, the Messenger of Allah ag said, •jXaj JJSJ j*J Li Lfrlijl 4j C-JJL>- U N jjLyw 'flxJ iu jl» « Verily, Allah the Exalted has forgiven my Ummah (Muslims) for what they talk (think) to themselves about, as long as they do not utter or implement i/." The statement of Allah the Exalted, Sf~ Jt 4i*' i^~j} ill Most of the scholars do not hold the same view as Ibn Kathir

regarding the usage of “We”

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5511–5535]

228 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr \$And We are nearer to him than his jugular vein.} means, His angels are nearer to man than his jugular vein. Those who explained ‘We’ in the Ayah to mean ‘Our knowledge,’ have done so to avoid falling into the idea of incarnation or indwelling; but these two creeds are false according to the consensus of Muslims. Allah is praised and glorified, He is far hallowed beyond what they ascribe to Him. The words of this Ayah do not need this explanation (that ‘We’ refers to ‘Allah’s knowledge’), for Allah did not say, ‘and I am closer to him than his jugular vein.’ Rather, He said, 4 Sr- U? ill iAnd We are nearer to him than his jugular vein.} just as He said in the case of dying persons, iBut We are nearer to him than you, but you see not.} (56:85), in reference to His angels (who take the souls). Allah the Exalted the Blessed said. 4U /j ']'>\$ Gy yi £[] iVerily, We, it is We Who have sent down the Dhikr and surely, We will guard it.} (15:9) Therefore, the angels brought down the revelation, the Qur’an, by the leave of Allah, the Exalted, the Most Honored. Thus, the angels are closer to man than his own jugular vein, by the power and leave of Allah. ' Consequently, the angel touches mankind, just as the

devil touches them, for the devil is as close to them as the blood that runs in their veins; just as Allah's Prophet who is truthful and was told the truth, told us. Allah's statement here, 4yG£j~X& i(Remember) that the two receivers receive,} in reference to the two angels who receive and record the deeds of mankind. m Path Al-Bari 1 1 :557

229 Surah 50. Oaf (16-22) (Part-26) i one sitting on the right and one on the left.} means ready to note, 4 whatever he utters in reference to the human, i o fa word}, means any word that he or she speaks, i but there is a watcher by him ready.} means, but there is a scribe whose job is to record it, leaving no word or movement unrecorded. Allah the Exalted said, i But verily, over you (are appointed angels) to watch you, Kiraman (I w n o r a b l e) Katibin writing d c n v n (your deeds), they k n o i v all that you do.} (82:10-12) Therefore, the scribe records every word that is spoken, according to the explanation of Al-Hasan and Qatadah. This is also the apparent meaning of this Ayah. Imam Ahmad recorded that Bilal bin Al-Harith Al-Muzani said, "The Messenger of Allah j g said, c-«L U <31 U <3)1 I j* i i l S C I L o b I f f I f; i l J>-j j p J i l l I f; 4-1 p U ^ J L; j l < u j l l a U L « Verily, a man might utter a word that pleases Allah the Exalted, unaware of how highly it will be regarded, and on its account Allah the Exalted and Most Honored decrees His pleasure of him until the Day he meets Him. A man might indeed utter a word that angers Allah the Exalted, unaware of how dreadful it will be and on its account Allah the Exalted decrees for him His anger until the Day he meets Him At-Tabari 22 :345.

230 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 'Alqamah used to say, "How many words did I not utter because of the Hadith that Bilal bin Al-Harith narrated." * At- Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah collected this Hadith. At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih.." *2 * Theie is a Hadith similar t^ this in the Sahih. Reminding Mankind of the Stupor of Death, the Blast of the Trumpet and the Day of Gathering Allah the Exalted and Most High said, ^ ^ L » illi'j i And the shipor of death to ill come in truth: "This is what you have been avoiding!"} Allah the Exalted and Most Honored says, 'O mankind! This is the stupor of death that has come in truth; now, I have brought forth to you the certainty that you were disputing,' 4X4 *-i {This is what you have been avoiding!}, means, this is the end that you were trying to escape; it has come to you! Therefore, you will have neither a shelter nor a refuge nor a sanctuary nor an asylum from it.' In the Sahih., the Prophet j g said, while wiping sweat from his face when the stupor of death overcame him, j j !<ul «Glory be to Allah! Verily, death has its stupor The Ayah, 4X* *4. £ ty>} 4 This is what you have been avoiding!} has two possible meanings. One of them is this: "what you have been trying to avert, escape and flee from has come to you and resided in your home!" The second meaning is, you had no way of escaping or averting this end.' At-Tabarani collected a Hadith in Al-Mu'jam * x * Ahmad 3 :469. * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:610, Tuhfat Al-Ashraf 2 :555 and Ibn Majah |3* Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :369

231 Surah 50. Oaf (16-22) Part-26) Al-Kabii from Samurah who said that the Messenger of Allah m said, lit i 4.Ua> »—J L u j J l O ^ U l , _£ j j l d j £ />» * ' >--h* l; d «o U j J j j i 5 J _) j j j l i i ^ U u- «The parable of whoever tries to avoid death is that of a fox that had a debt to pay to the earth. The fox wait a i o a y and when he became tired and the time to sleep overtook him, he entered his den. The earth said to him, 'O fox! Pay my debt!' The fox went out howling and continued until his neck was cutoff, (i.e.,) he died. This parable indicates that just as the fox had no way of escaping or avoiding the earth, likewise, man has no way of avoiding death. Allah the Exalted the Blessed said, i And the Trumpet will be blown - that will be the Day of the threat.} Earlier we discussed the information about the blowing of the Trumpet, the fear that

follows it, the death of everything and then resurrection, all this will occur on the Day of Resurrection. 21 We also mentioned that the Messenger of Allah jfe said in a Hadith, jijj jl ujjill Jii j'f&\ -W9J "Hoiv can I feel comfort xohile the angel responsible for the Trumpet has placed the Trumpet to his mouth and lowered his forehead awaiting what he will be commanded (by Allah to blow in it)? They said, "O Allah's Messenger, what should we say?" He jfe said, p-dj Jii Ulii \JJ ** At-Tabarani 7:222. This narration is Mawquf, i.e., it is correct from the Companion only * See volume six, the Tafsir of Surah TaHa (20 : 102)

233Surah 50. Oaf(23-29) (Part-26) J2 Siiy; y*_yU^L»j ;j£lo;Z.J0'lu^X*3 \$ iilK> <jj -Lj£Al4 ^/^XcS^ *-iJ^~Vr'U ^ o4j\jt^oiS*3yijcjfc\^b'y^i3y>fjj ja.-aC- j^JujJiyUUC*^J,*>JfijulJl-ci' djitj(: "C-j<- f^cf^L£hy\$ 'your sight is now clear and strong.' Everyone, including the disbelievers, will have clear sight on

the Day of Resurrec- tion. However, having sight will not be helpful to the dis- believers on that Day, for Allah the Exalted said, 4&j>'k (J (*£ gff 4Hcnv clearly will they (disbelievers) see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us!4 (19:38), and, [y& H i&4 jl> Jk-4tr> pi~*Jk> Q S**3 iAnd ifyou only could see when the criminals hang their heads before their Lord (saying) : "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back (to the world), that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty>(32: 12) Cv jfijl jj£2 . T< 'J_* jli£=» 'flfr 4 >^3 ^ t—j Z (Lj Xt) jt "ff. j»a2J* yiJui' 4 'C^** >*• £ 4*»- % C M^ Sj S3 V jli : ry ' " " £ Ji*- cfjJ 1 „y/ -4-ju v t. »» ; ,/ irt rtir . 'W tVl 1.. ' S' 423. And his companion (angel) will say: "Here is (his record) ready with me!" 424. (Allah will say to the angels:) "Both of you throzv into

Hell every stubborn disbeliever") 425. "Hinderer ofgood, transgressor, doubter,") 426. "Who set up another god with Allah. Then both of you cast him in the severe torment.") 427. His companion (devil) will say: "Our Lord! I did not push him to transgression, but he was himself in error far astray.") 428. (Allah) will say: "Dispute not in front of Me, I had already in advance sent you the threat.") 429. "The sentence that comes from Me cannot be changed, and I am not unjust to the servants.") The Angel will bear Witness; Allah commands that the Disbelieverbe thrown into the Fire Allah the Exalted states that the scribe angel, who is entrusted with recording the deeds of mankind, will testify against him or her about the deeds he or she did on the Day of Resurrection. He will say, cf-u u 4"Here is (his record) ready with me!"), here it is prepared and completed without addition or deletion. This is when Allah the Exalted willjudge the creation with fairness, saying, 4Both ofyou throw into Hell every stubborn disbeliever.) It appears that Allah will say these words to the Sa'iq and Shahid angels; the Sa'iq drove him to the grounds where Reckoning is held and the Shahid testified. Allah the Exalted will order them to throw him in the fire of Jahannam, and worse it is as a destination, 4Both ofyou throw into Hell every stubborn disbeliever.) meaning, whose disbelief and denial of truth was horrendous, who used to stubbornly i eject the truth, knowingly contradicting it with falsehood,

235Surah 50. Oaf (23-29) (Fart-26) iHinderer of good,^ meaning for he did not fulfill the duties he was ordered, nor was he dutiful, keeping ties to kith and kin nor giving charity, itransgressor meaning, he transgresses the limits in spending. Qatadah commented, "He is a transgressor in his speech, behavior and affairs."* 11 Allah said. idoubter meaning, he doubts and raises doubts in those who scrutinize his behavior iwho set up another god with Allah.} meaning, he associated others with Allah and

worshipped others besides Him, 4 wJjJi 4 iThen both ofyou cast him in the severe torment> Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that

the Prophet jg said, Jv- lr“J 'yt y* - Jt p-fcl* 4 py jii ^ jiil p-4=r »A neck from the Fire will appear and will speak saying, “Today, I have been entrusted with three: Every obstinate tyrant, everyone who ascribed another god zoith Allah, and he who took a life loithout right.” The neck ivill then close in on them and throw than in the midst ofJahannam .b”*2 Man and Devil dispute before Allah Allah’s saying; iHis companion will say\$, refers to the devil who is entrusted to 111 At-Jabari 22 :356. 121 Ahmad 3:40.

— Tafstr Ibn Kathir every man, according to ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Qata- dah and several othesJ'l He will say, iOur Lord! I did not push hint to transgression, meaning, the devil will say this about the human who came on the Day of Resurrection as a disbeliever. The devil will disown him, saying, 4Our Lord! I did not push him to transgression^ meaning, “I did not lead him astray,” <4& ibut he ivas himself in errorfar astray.^ meaning, he himself was misguided, accepting falsehood and stubborn to the truth. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said in another Ayah, o? Cj cjj Jil j£j ill U jiLiili U U ijij15 J fis-j J V) 'J ^•4* (*A 0[oi A •~‘A^=‘ Jj, “^Lkr^y ty Shaytan will say when the matter has been decided: “Verily, Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. So blame me not, but blame yourselves. I cannot help you, nor can you help me. I deny yourformer act in associating me as a partner with Allah. Verily, there is a painful torment for the wrongdoers.”4 (14:22) Allah the Exalted said, i(Allah) will say : “Dispute not in front ofMe.”4 The Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored will say this to the man and his devil companion, who will be disputing before m At-Tabari 22 :357.

237Surah 50. Oaf (30-35) (Part-26) Him. The man will say, “O, Lord! This devil has misguided me away from the Remembrance after it came to me,” while the devil will declare, iOitr Lord! I did not push him to transgression, but he was himself in errorfar astray.> from the path of truth. The Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored will say to them, v} iDispute not in front ofMe,} or ‘before Me,’ 4/ had already in advance sent you the threat.} i have given you sufficient proof by the words of the Messengers, and I have sent down the Divine Books; the evidences, signs and proofs have thus been established against you,’ jyK jili C} 4The Sentence that comesfrom Me cannot be changed,} “I have made My decision,” according to the explanation of Mujahid,111 4jJ% (3 4And I am not unjust to the servants.} 1 will not punish anyone, except on account of their sins after the proof has been established against them.’ lii'i yii &.J t-ji 14.4? 44 ^>*^4 u p» 430. Oh the Day when We will say to Hell: “Are you filled?” It will say : “Are there any more?”} m At-Tabari 22 :359

23S Tafsir Ibn Kathir 431 . And Paradise will be Uzlifat to those who had Taqwd, not far ojf.\$ \$32. (It will be said): "This is what you were promised - (it is) for those rehimmg in cinccre repentance, and Hafiz. " } \$33. "Who feared Ar-Rahmdn unseen and brought a heart turned in repentance." } 434. “Enter you therein in peace and security - this is a Day of eternal life!” } 435. There they will have all that they desire - and I Ve have more.} Jahannamand Paradise and their Dwellers Allah states that He will say to Jahannam on the Day of Resurrection, “Have you had your fill?” Allah the Most Honored has promised Hell that it will have its fill from the Jinns and mankind. He, the Exalted and Most Honored, will decide

who will be thrown into the Firs and she will keep saying, “Are there any more,” or, ‘Are there any more whom You will provide me with?’ This is the apparent meaning of this Ayah which is supported by several Hadiths. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *“Lj j doi 'dyCj J'y Y 1 ^j j ^ id • dyCj jP) 1 g ., <i <S1 'jjd ULi- L\$J ail J-oi ”*The people will be thrown into Jahannam and it will say, ‘Are there any more?’ Until the Mighty Lord puts His Foot over it and its comers will be collected together and it will say, “Enough, enough by Your grace and compassion!” There will be sufficient empty space in Paradise until Allah creates another creation and He, the Exalted, makes them dwell in the empty parts of Paradise .a”* 11 Muslim also collected this HadithP^ Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah narrated that the 111 Ahmad 3:234. ,2) Muslim 4:2187 and 2188.

240 Tafslr Ibn KathTr 4And Paradise will be Uzlifat to those who had Taqwd, not far meaning, Paradise will be brought close and near to the pious, according to Qatadah, Abu Malik and As-Suddi,m 4& inot far off}, and this will occur on the Day of Resurrection, which is not far off. Surely that Day will come to pass and all that is bound to come, is near, iThis is what you were promised - (it is) for those returning} who go back to Allah in sincere repentance intending not to repeat sin, 4Hafiz}, who preserve their covenant with Allah and do not break or betray it, &&&& 4Who feared Ar-Rahman unseen who feared Allah in secret when only Allah the Exalted and Most Honored could see him. The Prophet jg said, •olllp <ii\ 'ft jfijt "And a man who remembered Allah the Exalted while alone, and his eyes became tearful . Allah said, iand brought a heart turned in repentance.} meaning, he will meet Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, on the Day of Resurrection with a heart turned in repentance to Him and absolutely free (of Shirk) and humbled to Him, 4Z,p>\} At-Tabari 22:363. Fath Al-Bari 2:168. That is, one of those under the shade of the Throne

Allah the Exalted and Most Honored: ﴿ 4- this is a Day of eternal life! 〉, meaning, they will reside in Paradise forever and will never die, neither be transferred from it nor wish to be transferred from it. The statement of Allah the All-Mighty, ﴿ 4- There they will have all that they desire 〉, means, whatever delights they wish and desire, they will find it brought before them. Allah's statement, ﴿ And We have more. 〉 is similar to His other statement, ﴿ For those who have done good is the best and even more. 〉 (10:26) In the Sahih, Muslim recorded that Suhayb bin Sinan Ar-Rumi said that 'more' refers to looking at the Most Honorable Face of Allah. 2 ' 61 ij \jX* til* ^ iil jii pafe 'Sj} O jttij ..rv, ,x. ^ y>j jl iii jJ Jjj'i ,jj U 3^ .r A , .. \Sj iL- u '» 4-^ Uj v*^ 0*5 <33j <35 <%> m At-Tabari 22 :366 Muslim 1 :163

436. And how many a generation We have destroyed before them who were stronger in power than they. And they went about the land! Could they find any place of refuge? 437. Verily, therein is indeed a reminder for him who has a heart or gives ear while he is heedful. 438. And indeed We created the heavens and the earth and all between them in six Days and nothing of fatigue touched Us. 439 . So bear with patience all that they say, and glorify the praises of your Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting. 440. And during a part of the night (also) glorify His praises and (so likewise) after the prostrations. Warning the Disbelievers of the imminent Torment; commanding the Prophet jg to pray and have Patience Allah the Exalted asks, 'how many We have destroyed before these denying disbelievers?' 4a generation who were stronger in power than they they were more numerous, mightier than they and who constructed on the earth and built on it more than they. The statement of Allah the Exalted, 4And they went about the land! Could they find any place of refuge? Ibn 'Abbas commented, "They left the traces throughout the land," 1 11 Qatadah said, "They traveled throughout the land seeking provisions through trade and business, more than you have. " Allah's statement, ioifr-* Oi 4Could they find any place of refuge? means, 'could they find a shelter from Allah's decision and appointed destiny? Have what At-Tabari 22:371

243 Surah 50. Oaf(36-40) (Port-26) they collected benefited them or averted Al'ah's torment when it came to them on account of their denial of the Messengers? Likewise, you will never be able to nvert avoid, or find refuge or shelter (from His torment).' Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, la-1 l)> 4Verily, therein is indeed a reminder* and a lesson, 4for him who has a heart> meaning, a sound understanding with which he comprehends, or, a good mind, according to Mujahid, 4a- 3 ? 4or gives ear ivhile he is heedful.} meaning, he hears the speech, comprehends and understands it in his mind and grasps its indications with his intellect. Mujahid said that, J\ }} ior gives ear}, means, he does not talk to himself but listens with an attentive heart. Ad-Dahhak commented, "The Arabs would say that someone has given ear when he hears with his ears, while his heart is present and not absent." 121 Ath-Thawri and several others said similarly. The statement of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored; jt i* \$1*1 uj j .*.—i ' l 'hi. 3eeij} } And indeed We created the heavens and the earth and all that betioeen them in six Day? and nothing of fatigue touched Us.} is emphasis on the Resurrection because He Who is able to create the heavens and earth without fatigue, then surely He is able to resurrect the dead. Qatadah said, "The Jews, may Allah's curses descend on them, said that Allah created the heavens and earth in six days and then rested on the seventh day, which was the Sabbath. This is why they call it a holiday. Allah the Exalted then sent down denial of their statement 111 At-Tabari 22:373. 121 At-Tabari 22 :374 131 At-Tabari 22 :374

244 Tafslr Ibn KathTr and false opinion.” Allah said, Uj» 4and nothing of fatigue touched Us3 indicating that no sleep, exhaustion or weariness affects Him. Allah the Exalted the Blessed said in other Ayat, 'Sf-. ill bifP oft (4j 'l) 3*- J !>y. 4 ih 4P' 4Do they not see that Allah, Who created the Iteavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is Able to do all things.^ (46:33), 4The creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind.> (40:57) and, i&> J li£ 13p3 4Are you more difficult to create or is the heaven that He constructed?^ (79:27) Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said. 4So bear with patience all that they say in reference to those who deny the Prophet ordering him to be patient with them and turn away from them in a good way, SSj fep 35 ct--j¥ 4and glorify the praises of your Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting3 There were two ordained prayers prior to the Isra' journey. One before the rising of the sun at dawn and the other before sunset in the evening. Qiyam Al-Layl, prayer at night, was a command for the Prophet and his followers for sometime but it was later abrogated for the Ummah. Later, during the Isra' journey, Allah abrogated all of the previous orders for prayer by ordaining five daily prayers, including the prayers of m At-Tabari 22 :376.

Fajr before sunrise, and 'Asr in the late afternoon. Imam Ahmad recorded that Jarir bin 'Abdullah said, “When we were sitting with the Prophet jg, he looked at the full moon and said, J 5 jjj LIS' 'jjfi OyJ>yCS* ^SLj] lif» yS)^ {JL jj j* \j& vM j&tiii “Certainly you will be brought before your Lord and will see Him as you see this moon, and you will have no trouble in seeing Him . So, if you can avoid missing the prayer before the sunrise and the prayer before sunset, you must do so. He then recited Allah's statement, iand glorify the praises of your Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting The Two Sahths and the rest of the Group collected this Hadith through the chain of Ismail.121 Allah the Exalted said. iAnd during a part of the night glorify His praisesK meaning pray to Him. Allah said Ayah, • ' , ' L»uL 4And in some parts of the night offer the Salah with it, as an additional prayer for you. It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud. (17:79) Ibn Abi Najih reported that Mujahid said that Ibn 'Abbas said that, iand after the prostrations .> refers to Tasbih, i.e. glorifying Allah's Ahmad 4:365. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8:462, Muslim 1 :439, Abu Dawud 5:97, Tuhfat At- Ahwadhi 7 :265, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra, 6:469 and Ibn Majah 1 :63.

praises, after the prayers. There is a Hadith collected in the Two Sahihs that supports this meaning. Abu Hurayrah said, “Some poor migrants came ar.n said, 'O Allah's Messenger! The wealthy people will get higher grades and will have permanent enjoyment.' The Prophet ag said, nl'Vhi/ is that? * They said. They pray as we do, fast as we do, yet they give charity, but we can not. They free slaves, but we can not.' The Prophet sg said, «SJw/i / te/1 yoH about something that, if you did it, you would catch up with those who have surpassed you and nobody would be better than you except those who would do the same? Say, 'Subhan Allah, Alhamdulillah and Allahu Akbar,' thirty-thiee times each after every prayer .» Later, they came back and said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Our brethren, the wealthy Muslims, heard of what we did and they also did the same.' The Prophet said, tills If «This is a favor and grace of Allah, and He grants it tc whom He. willsyW There is another way of explaining the Ayah. It is that Allah's statement. 4and after the prostrations refers to the two Rak'ahs after the Maghrib prayer. This was reported from TJmar bin Al-Khattab, 'Ali bin Abi Talib and his son Al-Hasan, 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Abu Hurayrah and Abu Umamah, may Allah be pleased with them. This is also the saying of

Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ash-Sha'bi, An-Nakhal, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, and others. AMabari 22:381. 121 Path Al-Bari 2 :378

r <ss,,te "• vs, .->» ,, . .f<v \jl-^r-ibfcg e ,, ~7 ,, - -t; , , ^ fj> ^ *y? "ir ,^:Tr -'T- « - . , ' ^ bl f-«^ qij 44;^ ^ j^Vi ^Jiij y>5<j2 C. >1^ J4. pj£ <S^ Gj 44yJ jUJi jj^ilf^ijj; 4 '|?pj-*> >ji^ ,> o'v^X 442. And //sten on f/ie j>.tff ^ > ^U""m'* *' -*>•' Day when the caller will , nearplace > 'ojj&tpt? <42. The Day when ^ •?".'v- ~ - <r,,* they will hear As-Sayhah lUj in truth/ that wUl be the Day o/coming out.} ~ 443. Verily, it is We —l Who gie /i/e and cause \$£jciLafi & death; and t0 Us is the \$ 444 . On the Day when the earth shall be cleft, from off them (they will come out) hastening forth. That will be a gathering, quite easyfor Us.} <45. We know best what they say. And you are not the one to force them. But warn by the Qur'an; him whofearsMy threat.} Admonition from Some Scenes of the Day of Resurrection Allah the Exalted said, i{pj¥ <And listen 'O Muhammad,' 4ytr* yfi j; jfi' X fs} <on the Day zohen the caller will callfrom a near place.} cj\yjCi j:^\.1_ '3p-*'i>J*cAp-4jb^=Jj>l ufs-^ J^jGU' L-iUJid,^

248 Tafslr Ibn Kathir to the gathering for the Day of Judgement, }sft iThe Day when they will hear As-Sayhah in truth,} in reference to the blowing in the Trumpet which will bring forth the truth that most of them discounted and denied, ithat will be the Day ofcoming out.} from the graves, ^£ 6ft iVerily, it is We Who give life and cause death; and to Us is the final return.} Allah is He Who starts creation and then brings it back to life, and the latter is easier for Him; to Him is the final return of all creations. At this time, He will recompense each according to his or her deeds, good for good and evil for evil. Allah the Exalted said, iOn the Day when the earth shall be cleft, from off them (they will come out) hasteningforth.} Allah the Exalted and Most Honored will send down rain from the sky. From that rain the bodies of the creations will grow while they are in their graves, just as the seed grows in soil in the aftermath of rain. When the bodies grow to their full strength, Allah the Exalted will command angel Israfxl and he will blow in the Trumpet (for a second time). The souls will be enclosed in a hole in the Trumpet. When Israfil blows in the Trumpet, the souls will depart from it and will fly between the heavens and earth. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored, will declare, “By My grace and power, each soul shall return to the body that it used to inhabit,” and indeed, every soul will return to its body. The soul will enter its body just as poison enters the body, then the earth will be uncovered from above them, and they will all stand and head towards the Reckoning place hastening to obey the command of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored,

iHastening towards the caller. The disbelievers will say: "This is a hard Day.">(54:8), and 40n the Day when He will call you, and you will answer (His Call) with (words of) His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while!} (17:52) In the Sahih, it is recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Ait ^ Jjl lib «The earth will open up first around we.# Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, il& Ji- \$> } iThat will be a gathering, quite easy for Us.} 'bringing them back to life is easy for Us and effortless.' Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, 4 - 'j ^1 Cj} 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.^ (54:50), and, i y8 4 ^ \$pz %pi C} 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as of a single person. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} (31:28) Comforting the Prophet sg The statement of Allah the Exalted and Most High, \l j&i ££} 4We know best what they say.} means, ‘Our knowledge is all encompassing of the denial that the idolators are confronting m Muslim 4 :1782.

you with, so do not be concerned.’ In similar Ayat, Allah said, cAXgOzj! illij L*j ,3-ii viJbl jObj} 4S JDt Ji ^54® ilndeed, We know that your breast is straitened at what they say. So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those ivho prostrate themselves (to Him). And worship your Lord until tliere comes unto you the certainty (i.e., death).} (15:97) Allah’s statement, ^ %£} iAnd you are not the one to force them.} says, ‘it is not you who forces them to accept the guidance; this is not a part of your mission.’ Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, iBut warn by the Qur'an; him whofearsMy threat.} meaning, ‘convey the Message ofyour Lord, for only those who fear Allah and dread His torment, and hope in His promise will remember and heed,’ iX# i }Your duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning .^(13:40) oil T2jj jfii} <(So remind them - you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.)(88:21-22) i Sit 5%=eij il£ fci} }Not upon you is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills.){2:272) and, d*i iVerily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills.} (28:56) Allah’s statement here, i_3b> o’* jTjli yLs£ ii^ Ly

251Surah 50 , Oaf(41-45) (Part-26) iAnd you are not the one to force them. But warn by the Qur'an ; him whofearsMy threat. Qatadah used to invoke Allah by saying, “O Allah! Make us among those who fear Your threat and hope for Your promise, O Barr (Subtle, Kind, Courteous, and Generous), O Rahim (the Most Merciful).” 1 ^

Surah 51: Adh-Dhariyat

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Opening

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Opening The Tafsir of Surat Adh-Dhariyat (Chapter - 51) Which was revealed in Makkah oU <yr*-~>f ^j). Oj^>tjC~Z±Ai£s&iSJJU *5^poyf-j |j 'kr^r. [y£"§5 yib '4>\$vU/*®? fjpojh^ ^ t3^ ' L> i-j;>®{£0 yCtj ^ J»-iiUj I wijlf"b "i/ 1JL5 |^jLJ^yti Sjj}0w->J»uo*W^<=4jj&1 i^agaaPiS^ ^ ^C&JJjj-^J'-£'3'^%b'r£IS*yli^ 4* -;?•*£ * tii' i"- ' '* * ?'>< .s •< ._»?•? tfAjj?cJ cX»*,>^>J;<d/>'cX*Is Qp In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ,--4~^ .. i * [>jj ojj'jjtj^ ££?£S ^2iS :sC0 ££? Si j; 0 4^^ u-jJ' 1 ® , i3aw»5 ->4 «-v.^lxi cAj •' *•' *\.* -"•> ,./ •v ,y Alt *iU)j ;A_Jyd!^ Jj ooj? ji & 'f (j> ff&f \y. oQ {<- . ;! / - »'•> tfjjl '-Alb 'j»jj ,Vr , y~*t 'it (f® <2 . By the scattering Dhdiydt;} \2 . And the laden Hamilat;} 43. And the steady Jdriyat;} 44. And the distributors of command,} 45. Verily, that which you are promised is surely true.} 46. And verily, Ad-Din is sure to occur.}

253 Surah 51 . Adh-Dhriyat (1-14) (Part-26) 47. By the heaven full of Hubuk,) 48. Certainly, you have different ideas. 49. Turned aside therefrom is he who is hinted aside. 410. Cursed be Al-Kharrdsiin) 411 . Who are under a cover of Sdhun,) 412. They ask: "When will be the Day of Ad-Din?" 413. (It will be) a Day whet} they will be Yuftanun in the Fire!)' 414. "Taste you your trial! This is what you used to ask to be hastened!") Affirming the News of the Resurrection The Commander of the faithful, 'Ali bin Abi Talib may Allah be pleased with him, ascended the Minbar in Kufah and declared, "Any Ayah in the Book of Allah the Exalted and any Sunnah from Allah's Messenger gfe you ask me about today, I will explain them." Ibn Al-Kawwa stood up and said, "O Leader of the faithful! What is the meaning of Allah's statement, cSj'jilj) 4By the scattering Dhariydt)," and 'Ali said, "The wind." The man asked, 4And the laden Hamilat?)" 'Ali said, "The clouds." The man again asked, "4And the steady jariyat?)" 'Ali said, "The ships." The man asked, 4;W "4And the distributors of command?)" 'Ali said, it refers to "The angels." Some scholars said that Al-Jariydt Yusra refers to the stars that float in their orbits with ease. This would mean that the At-Tabari 22 :389-392 and 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :41

254 Tafsir Ibn Kathir things mentioned were ascendant in their order, beginning with the lower, then mentioning the higher one after that, etc. The winds bring the clouds, the stars ar" above them and the angels who distribute by Allah's order are above hat, and they descend with Allah's legislative orders and the decrees He determines. These Ayat con'ain a vow from Allah that Resurrection shall come to pass. Allah's statement, 4 Verily, that which you are promised is surely true.?, it is a truthftil promise, 4And verily, Ad-Din} the Recompense, 4will occur}, it will surely come to pass. Then Allah the Exalted said, 4By the heaven full of Hubuk,} Ibn 'Abbas said; "Full of beauty, grace, magnificence and perfection." 1 11 Mujahid, Ikrimah, Sa*Td bin Jubayr, Abu Malik, Abu Salih, As-Suddi, Qatadah, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, Ar-Rabi* bin Anas and others said similarly.*21 Ad- Dahhak, Al-Minhal bin 'Amr

and others said, "The meandering of the water, sand and plants when the wind passes over them; carving paths out of them, that is the Hubuk." All of these sayings return to the same meaning, that of beauty and complexity. The sky is high above us, clear yet thick, firmly structured, spacious and graceful, beautified with stars such as the sun and orbiting planets such as the moon and the planets of the solar system. The Differing Claims of the Idolators Allah the Exalted said, in At-Tabari 22:395-396. 2| At-Tabari 22:396-397.

6| Certainly, you have different that MeSSenS^ have differed it' dW»««w» commtr,,,x xr4 o"fo™"s*2r «enythifefJ--2J that I, is <> <Xu|< Allah sayl'^thtse'to'^r " fe «* > only for those who ar^m- comes 'he source of^who h ^r *£== said: ' may^ be pleased with him, and As-Suddi misguided is led away from it^t^f "'fc> "He wh» is s^toVa^"" said. - ae ..what .s mentioned in (SSrah) -AbJa This is <*£*»«&## MKhamJan ZTltlT""T «M80:17| • a]hah reported from Ibn 'Abbfs R SURRECTION "2I 'Abdur-Razzaq 4:242. At-Tabari 22 :400.

{Cursed be Al-Kharrasuti}, "Cursed be the doubters." 111 Mu'adh said similarly, may Allah be pleased with him. During one of his speeches he said, "Destroyed be the doubters." Qatadah said, "Al-Kharrasun are the people of doubt and suspicion." 121 Allah said; {Who are under a cover of Sahun,} Ibn 'Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others said; "In disbelief and doubt, they are heedless and playful." 131 Allah said, {"Kcfff jut\$"\$0 {They ask: "When will be the Day of Ad-Din?"} They utter this statement in denial, stubbornness, doubt and suspicion. Allah the Exalted replied, }0 {(It will be) a Day when they will be Yuftaniin in the Fire!} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and several others said that Yuftanun means punished . 141 Mujahid said: "Just as gold is forged in the fire." 151 A group of others also including Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Zayd bin Aslam, and Sufyan Ath-Thawri said, "They will be burnt." {Taste you your trial!}, Mujahid said, "Your burning " 161 while others said, "Your punishment." 'ti {This is what you used to ask to be hastened!} This will be said admonishing, chastising, humiliating and belittling them. Allah knows best. At-Tabari 22:399. 121 At-Tabari 22:400. 131 At-Tabari 22 :400-401 At-Tabari 22:402. At-Tabari 22:402. At-Tabari 22:403.

i* 1?^ p-rl f*x~J t* SS y>r j <> (*\$>^ <i> ^ jU^VCj Spij^r. ^ 4^ t>; ^U? iiyOj-tep Uj tjj JjpSi/'f* ^ Xj> ci'» jj 4igjjjiki ^2,* 2 jii j»J /i[u>;V^ Mjji <15. V'eri/y, those who have Taqwa will be in the midst of Gardens and Springs,} il6. Taking joy in the things which their Lord has given them. Verily, they were before this doers of good.} i!7. They used to sleep but little by night.} \$18. And in the hours before dawn, they were asking for forgiveness.} 419. And in their wealth there was the right of the Sa'il and the Mahrfa.} 420. And on the earth are signs for those who have faith with certainty.} 421. And also in yourselves. Will you not then see? 422. And in the heaven is your provision, and that which you are promised.} 423. Then by the Lord of the heaven and the earth, it is the truth, just as you can speak.} Qualities of Those Who have Taqwa and Their Reward Allah the Exalted informs about those who have Taqwa, that on the Day of their Return they will be amidst gardens and springs. To the contrary the miserable ones will be amidst torment, punishment, fire and chains. Allah said, 4Taking joy in the things which their Lord has given them.} His statement; 4Taking} describes the state of the people of Taqwa in the midst of gardens and springs. They will receive what their Lord gives them, meaning, delight, happiness and favors. Allah the

258 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Exalted and Most Honored said, iVerily, they were before that>, in the life of the world, i gooddoers} As He said: JH* ^ 4£«f and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!)>{69:24} Allah the Exalted described the good acts that they performed, iThey used to sleep but little at night. ^ The scholars of Tafsir have two opinions about this: The First Opinion The first is that, they used to spend a little part of every night awake. Ibn 'Abbas said, "Every night, they would worship Allah, even during a little part of the night."111 Qatadah narrated that Mutarrif bin 'Abdullah said, "Hardly a night would pass by them that they did not pray to Allah the Exalted and Most Honored, either in the beginning, or the middle of it." ' Mujahid said, "Only a few nights, if any, would they sleep through the night until the morning without praying Tahajjud.."31 Qatadah said similarly 41 Anas bin Malik and Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "They used to pray between Al- Maghrib and Al-'Isha.'."^ The Second Opinion They used to spend a little part of the night in sleep. This was preferred by Ibn Jarir. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: 111 At-Tabari 22:407. At-Tabari 22:407. At-Tabari 22:408. At-Tabari 22:408, At-Tabari 22:407-408.

iThey used to sleep but little by night}, "They performed voluntary night prayer and would not sleep during the night except a little. They were active and would continue until they were seeking forgiveness right before dawn." 'Abdullah bin Salam said, "When the Messenger of Allah arrived at Al-Madinah, people quickly gathered around him and I was among them. When I saw his face, I knew that it was not the face of a liar. The first statement I heard from him was, IjJL oJl 1 i ^Ulj «0 people! Feed with food, keep relations to kith and kin, spread the Salam, pray at night while people are asleep, and you will enter Paradise in peace .»"*2' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin "Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, «U^aUJ l J* It Isf ^ j| «Verily , there are lofty rooms in Paradise in which their outside can be seen from inside and their inside from the outside .» Abu Mdsa Al-Ash'ari said, "Who are they for, O Allah's Messenger?" He sg said, jit <— ovf Ifd 11For those who use soft speech, feed food and spend the night in voluntary prayer while people are asleep »*3' Allah said: i.And in the hours before dawn, they were asking for forgiveness.} At-Tabari 22:408-409. 121 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :187 Ahmad 2:173.

Mujahid and several others said: "They were performing Sa/dh." ' Others said that they would stand in prayer during the night and delayed asking Allah for forgiveness until the latter hours before dawn. As Allah, the Exalted the Blessed, said; iAnd those who seek forgiveness during the last hours of the night.>{3:17}; This is because it is better if asking for forgiveness is done while praying. It is confirmed in the Sahlh collections as well as others, from several Companions, that the Messenger of Allah jjg said, : Jyf? Jill iSi djil Jj'l id ji Jfj Jui '<il Ojn Ji^* Iri j* •^ JA ja . jdp j *Allah, the Most High, descends each night to the lowest heaven zohen the last third of the night remains. He says, "Is there anyone who is repenting so that 1 may accept his repentance? Is there anyone seeking forgiveness, so that I may forgive him? Is there anyone asking of Me, so that I may grant him his request?" until Fajr begins .»121 Many of the scholars of Tafstr said that when the Prophet Ya'qub said to his sons: ixfpj^ il will ask my Lord for forgiveness for i/o»^(12:98), he delayed doing so until the hours before dawn. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored said, M && 111 At-Tabari 22:413. 121 Path Al-Bari 3:35, 11:133 and 13:473, Muslim 1:521 and 523, Abu Dawud 2:77 and 5:101, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:471, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra, 4 :24 and Ibn Majah 1 :435.

4And in their wealth there was the right of the Sa'il and the Mahrum .} After Allah mentioned their quality of performing prayer, He then mentioned their quality of spending in charity and acts of compassion and kindness, 4And in their wealth there was the right}, a designated part which they dedicated to the Sa'il and Mahrum. The Sa'il is the poor who begs others, and he has a due right. As for the Mahrum, Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid said, "He is the poor person who does not receive a stipend." *** Meaning he does not receive a stipend from the Muslim treasury, nor does he have a means of income, nor a profession. The Mother of the faithful, 'A'ishah may Allah be pleased with her, said about the Mahrum, "He is the displaced, the one who does not have a profession to easily earn an income from." Qatadah and Az-Zuhri: "The Mahrum is the one who does not ask the people for anything."*2 * Az-Zuhri added that the Messenger of Allah sg said, 3 OLu-iDlj - aUl * aJLc- JaJJj <J jhjj 'Ij JJ l . i i j la 1L I ^ V ^jj t «The poor (Misktn) is not the one who goes round to the people and asks them for a mouthful or two or a date or hvo. But the poor is the one who does not have enough to satisfy his needs and whose condition is not known to others, so that others may give him something in charity. This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs using another chain of narration.*4 Allah's Signs on the Earth and in Mankind Allah the Exalted and the Blessed said next, (1 * Af-Tabari 22:414. * At-Jabari 22:416. * An-Nasab , 5 :85. ' Fath Al-Bari 3 :399 and Muslim 2 :719

iAnd on the earth are signs for those who have faith with certainty.) Allah says that there are signs on earth that testify to the might of the Creator and His boundless ability. These signs include what Allah placed on the earth, the various plants, animals, valleys, mountains, deserts, rivers and oceans. He also created mankind with different languages, colors, intentions and abilities, and a variety among them, differences in the power of understanding and comprehension, their deeds, and ultimately earning happiness or misery. Allah put every organ in their bodies in its rightful place where they most need it to be. So He said; iAtid also in yourselves. Will you not then see?) Qatadah commented, "He who thinks about his own creation will realize that he was created with flexible joints so that it is easy for him to perform acts of worship."111 Allah the Exalted said next, iAnd in the heaven is your provision,) meaning, rain, Cj) iand that which you are promised.) meaning Paradise. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and several others.*21 Allah said: ^ A\ . ju-1 * ^vy) iThen by the Lord of the heaven and the earth, it is the truth, just as you can speak.) Allah is swearing by His honorable Self, all of the matters of the Judgement, Resurrection, and Recompense that they have been promised shall certainly occur. Therefore, it is the truth. 111 Al-Qurtubi 17:40. 121 At-Tabari 22:420.

263Surah 51 . Adh-Dhariyat (24-30) (Part-26) there being no doubt about it, so do not doubt its coming, just as you do not doubt that you can speak When he would talk to one of his friends, Mu'adh used to say: "What I am saying is as true as your being here." 'p 3& <x. & >> "i' Jti ill ciwi 4 cJjti ^p-?r!p (ji* U^r'j ^ ^ 4£|p>-p' -liAT) Jtt ijlll jllf cJGj 424. Has the story reached you, of the honored guests of Ibrahim?} 425. When they came in to him and said: "Saldman!" He answered: "Salamun" and said: "You are a people unknown to me."} 426. Then he turned to his household, and brought out a roasted calf.} 427. And placed it before them (saying): "Will you not eat?}" 428. Then he conceivedfear of them (when they ate not). They said: "Fear not." And they gave him glad tidings of a son having knowledge.} 429. Then his wife came forward with a loud voice; she smote herface, and said: "A barren old woman!"} 430. They said: "Even so says your Lord. Verily, He is the All-Wise, the All-Knower.}" The Guests ofthe Prophet Ibrahim We mentioned this stoij before in Surah Hud and Al-

Hijr}^ Allah said, S*} 4Has the story reached you, of the honored guests of Ibrahim}, whom Ibrahim honored and who, 4J2b (36&& t 1 * See volume five, the Tafsir of Sarah Hud (1 1 :69) , and the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hijr (15 :51)

264 TafsTr Ibn Kathir ithey said: "Saldman!" He answered: "Saldmun."} iWhen you are greeted with a greeting, greet in return with

The meaning of this Ayah (51:56) is that, Allah the Exalted, the Blessed created the creatures so that they worship Him Alone without partners. Those who obey Him will be rewarded with the best rewards, while those who disobey Him will receive the worst punishment from Him. Allah stated that He does not need creatures, but rather, they are in need of Him in all conditions. He is alone their Creator and Provider. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said, Jj ">U_i bjXCff "Allah the Exalted said, "O Son of Adam! Busy yourself in worshipping Me, and I will fill your chest with riches and dissipate your meekness. Otherwise, I will fill your chest with distracting affairs and will not do away xvith your meekness."^2' At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah collected this Hadith and At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Gharib. "(31 The statement of Allah the Exalted, iAnd verily, for those who do wrong, there is a portion}, indicates that they will receive their due share of the torment, Hike the evil portion (which came for) their likes (of old); so let them not askMe to hasten on!} let them not ask that the punishment is rushed to them, for it will surely come, Abu Dawud 4:290, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:261 and An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :469 Ahmad 2 :358 . Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :166 and Ibn Majah 2 :1376

iip OJ lt^s» CfM iTThen woe to those who disbelieve from their Day which they have been promised meaning, the Day of Resurrection.

Surah 52: At-Tur

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5563–5579]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAt-Tur, (Chapter - 52) Whichwas revealed in Malrimh The Virtues ofSuratAt-T&r• • Malik narrated that Jubayr bin Mutlm said, “I heard the Prophet ig reciting Surat At-Tur while praying Maghrib. Surely, I have never heard a more beautiful voice or recitation than his recitation.”¹¹¹ This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahths using a chain of narration that includes Malik. Al-Bukhari recorded that Umm Salamah said, “I complained of being ill to the Messenger of Allah jg, and he said, •&i; t'jju «Perform fawSf (of the Ka'bah) behind the crowd, while you are ridings So, I performed Tawaf while the Messenger of Allah was praying beside the House, reciting At-Tfir.”^{*3} In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. * % t }y. i#jr 4 oj' 35 jj-Jj Hi ^ jx 'J3\ .ii ^ jC. J|_ 'jpl C C2| j^lc f[>- luui 'J \$ \x/f& llJL''' V^ Y "As •£ ' Al-Muwatta' 1 :78. * Fath Al-Bdri2 :289 and Muslim 1 :338 131 FathAl-BOri8:468.

280 Tafslr Ibn Kathir⁴². By the Tilr} 42 . And the Book inscribed⁴³. In parchment unrolled. ⁴⁴. And by Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur.} ⁴⁵. And the roof raised high .} ⁴⁶. And by the sea that is Masjiir.} ⁴⁷. Verily, the torment ofyour Lord will surely come to pass.} ⁴⁸. There is none that can avert it.} ⁴⁹. On the Day when Tamur the heaven Mawr,} ⁴¹⁰. And TasTr the mountains Sayr.} ⁴²¹ . Then woe that Day to those who denied.} ⁴²². Those who were, in theirfalsehood, playing.} ⁴²³. The Day when they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing.} ⁴¹⁴. This is the Fire which you used to deny.} ⁴²⁵. Is this magic or do you not see?} ⁴²⁶. Enter therein and whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you used to do.} Allah swears that the Coming ofTorment is Near Allah swears by His creation, a testimony to His great ability, that His torment will surely befall His enemies; they will have no way of escaping it. At-Tur is the mount that has trees, similar to the mount where Allah spoke to Mdsa, while Musa was on it, and the mount on which Allah started the prophethood of Isa. A mount that does not have trees is called Jabal, not Tur. Allah said, 4\$^ 4And by the Book inscribed}, it is said that it means Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz, (the Preserved Table). It is also said that is refers to the divinely revealed inscribed Books that people recite, and this is why Allah said,

iln parchment unrolled. And by Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur.} In the Two Sahihs it is confirmed that the Messenger of Allah jg said in the Hadith about Al-Isra', after ascending to the seventh heaven: i Uji Ojn.?'* S <L>-Jb jA ISIJ i JI ' "Then, I was taken to Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur. It is visited every day by seventy thousand angels who will not come back to visit it again. n 1 * 1 The angels worship Allah in Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur and perform Tawafaround it just as the people of the earth perform Tawaf around the Ka'bah. Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur is the Ka'bah of those who reside in the seventh heaven. During the Isra'

journey, the Prophet saw Ibrahim Al-Khalil, who was reclining with his back on Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur. It was Ibrahim who built the Ka'bah on earth, and surely, the reward is compatible with the action. Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur is parallel to the Ka'bah; every heaven has its own house of worship, which is also the direction of prayer for its residents. The house that is located in the lower heaven, is called Bayt Al-'Izzah. And Allah knows best. The statement of Allah the Exalted, 4 yip" iAnd by the roof raised high.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Shu'bah, and Abu Al-Ahwas, all narrated from Simak, from Khalid bin 'Ar'arah, from 'Ali bin Abi Talib: iAnd by the roof raised high} "Meaning the heaven." Sufyan added, "Then 'Ali recited, iAnd We have made the heaven a roof, safe and well-guarded Yet they turn away from its signs.^(21:32) "21 *** Fath Al-Bari 6 :349 and Muslim 1 :150. ,2) At-Tabari 22:257-258.

Similar was said by Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ibn Jurayj, Ibn Zayd and preferred by Ibn Jarir.¹¹ ' The statement of Allah the Exalted, 4And by the sea that is Masjur.} The majority say it refers to the oceans of the earth. Masjur, means, the sea will be kindled with fire on the Day of Resurrection just as Allah said in another Ayah, 4And when the seas become as blazing fire.}(81:6) i.e., it will be kindled with fire and become a raging fire that surrounds the people in the gathering area, this was reported by Said bin Al-Musayyib from 'Ali bin Abi Talib.'² It was also reported from Ibn 'Abbas, and it is the view of Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, 'Abdullah bin TJBayd bin TJmayr and others. Qatadah said, "Masjur is the filled sea." Ibn Jarir preferred this explanation saying, "The sea is not lit with fire now, so it is filled." Allah's statement; iVerily, the torment of your Lord will surely come to pass.} contains the subject of the vow, indicating that His torment will surely strike the disbelievers, as Allah stated in another Ayah if. %^ iThere is none that can avert it.} indicating that when Allah decides to send the torment upon them, none can prevent it or stop it from striking them. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Ibn Abi Ad-Dunya recorded that Jafar bin Zayd Al-'Abdi said, "One night, in Al-Madlnah, 'Umar went out investigating the welfare of Muslims and passed by the house of a man who was standing in voluntary prayer. "Umar stood 111 At-Tabari 22:458. 121 At-Tabari 22:458.

quietly, listening to his recitation; the man was reciting, 4By At-Tur}, until he reached the Ayah, ot ^ ^ v'J iVerily, the torment of your Lord will surely come to pass. There is none that can avert it.} Umar said, 'Ey the Lord of the Ka'bah, this is a true vow.' 'Umar dismounted his donkey and sat next to a wall for a while. He then went back to his house and fell ill for a month. During his illness, the people would visit him, not knowing what caused his illness." May Allah be pleased with 'Umar. Describing the Day of Torment, the Day of Resurrection Allah said; <E£if&0 iOn the Day when Tamur the heaven Mawr} Ibn 'Abbas and Qatadah said: "Shaking violently." 1 11 Also from Ibn 'Abbas, "Split." Mujahid said: "Spin violently." Ad-Dahhak commented on the Ayah, saying, "The earth will violently spin and move by the command of Allah, and its areas will violently move towards each other."¹²¹ This was preferred by Ibn Jarir, because of the meaning of the word, Mawra, which denotes meanings of spinning and shaking. Allah scud, iAnd Tasir the mountains will Sayr.} will fade away and become scattered particles of dust blown away by the wind, iThen woe that Day to those who denied}, woe to them that Day as a result of Allah's torment, punishment and affliction that He will direct at them, At-Tabari 22:462. At-Jabari 22:362.

284 Tafsir Ibtī Katlīr 4 fl i/Ji) iThose who were in their falsehood, playing. meaning, they live in this life in falsehood and make the religion the subject of their mockery and jest, 4The Day when they will be pushed down by forced meaning, they will be violently driven and shoved, (~4*- £ 4to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing.) Mujahid, Ash-Sha'ī, Muhammad bin KaT), Ad-Dahhak, As- Suddi and Ath-Thawri said that this Ayah means, "They will be violently shoved into the Fire." Allah said, *4;^ j&> i&b 4This is the Fire, which you used to deny.) meaning, the angels of punishment will say these words to them, while admonishing and chastising them, V p ijo 4Is this magic or do you not see? Enter therein) meaning, enter the Fire, 'which will encircle you from every direction,' iand whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same.) 'whether you endure its torment and afflictions or not, you will never avert it or be saved from it,' i&i ;ir £& c>) 4You are only being requited for what you used to do.) and surely, Allah is never unjust with anyone. Most certainly, Allah recompenses each according to their deeds. I 1 ' At-Tabari 22 :464 and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :631

285 Surah 52. At-Tur (17-20) (Part-27) r-J} »Tt wiz&m Vi Liiu^uu^L/I iS^J 'jjsA* j 1-iiA OjCy^u([p ; £osl^i5i\$ i^JiJSMuy-1' / --" ' / ^«/ >r j Ojiljl H^Jj) jfrjj (y+^» L* uH^l l>^" ••P -»-^»4-' v'-^ fi^pj & % £ £ i*i\$ y_— Jf lju,c)>L*ju ». v«r- "r •* .i 4nVv^» 417. Verily, those who have Taqwa will be in Gardens and Delight.} 418. Enjoying in that which their Lord has bestowed on them, and (the fact that) their Lord saved them from the torment of the blazing Fire.} 419. "Eat and drink with happiness because of what you used to do."} 420. They will recline on thrones Masfufah. And We shall marry them to Hur (fair females) with wide lovely eyes.} Description of the Destination of the Happy Allah the Exalted described the destination of the happy ones, ^Ps^j 4 4Verily, those who have Taqwa will be in Gardens and Delight.} in contrast to the torment and punishment of the miserable; 4fe ^* c^a} 4Enjoying in that which their Lord has bestowed on them,}

meaning, enjoying the various types of delight that Allah has granted them therein, such as various types of foods, drinks, clothes, dwelling places, mounts, and so forth, iand (the fact that) their Lord saved them from the torment of the blazing Fire.} He saved them from the torment of the Fire, which is a bounty itself. Added to this blessing is the fact that they were entered into Paradise, which has delights that no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, nor has a heart ever imagined. The statement of Allah the Exalted, 4"Eat and drink with happiness because of what you used to do"} is similar to another of His statements, iEat and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!}(69:24) meaning this is the just reward for your deeds; surely, all this is a favor from Allah and a reward from Him. Allah the Exalted said, iThey will recline (with ease) on thrones Masjufah.} Ath-Thawri reported from Husayn, from Mujahid, from Ibn 'Abbas: "Thrones in howdahs." And the meaning of, iMasfufah} is they will be facing each other, 4Facing one another on thrones.>(37:44) Allah said next, iixe iAnd We shall marry them to Hur (fair females) with wide lovely eyes.}

We made for them righteous spouses, beautiful wives from Al- Hur Al-'Ayn. We mentioned the description of Al-Hur Al-'Ayn in several other places in this Tafsir, and therefore, it is not necessary to repeat their description here. y oi Zj ^ Gilt # r&? <\$j jjjj p?' 4jfe SfpSjs Vj fe C& tujj 4 £ g£=, % \ji fZ0Z S* , -dl. »j*A Oi ^=» 42f . And those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith, - to them shall We join their offspring, and We shall not decrease the reward of their deeds in anything. Every person is a pledge for that which he has earned.\$ 422. And We shall provide them with fruit and

meat such as they desire. 423. There they shall pass from hand to hand a cup, free from any idle talk, and free from sin. } 424. And there will go round boy-servants of theirs, to serve them as if they were preserved pearls. } 425. And some of them draw near to others, questioning. } 426. Saying: "Aforetime, we were afraid in the midst of our families." } 427. "So Allah has been gracious to us, and has saved us from the torment of the Fire." } 428. "Verily, We used to invoke Him before. Verily, He is the Most Subtle, the Most Merciful." } The Offspring of Righteous Believers will be elevated to Their Grades in Paradise In this Ayah, Allah the Exalted affirms His favor, generosity, graciousness, compassion and beneficence towards His creation. When the offspring of the righteous believers imitate (1 * See the Tafsir of Surat Ar-Rahman (55:56 and 72) and As-Saffat (37 :48-49) , and Ad-Dukhan (44 :54)

their parents regarding faith, Allah will elevate the latter to the ranks of the former, even though the latter did not perform deeds as goodly as their parents. Allah will comfort the eyes of the parents by seeing their offspring elevated to their grades. Surely, Allah will gather them together in the best manner, and He will not decrease the reward or the grades of those higher in rank for joining them together, hence His statement, 4/ ^ jJ is, l& } ito them shall We join their offspring, and We shall not decrease the reward of their deeds in anything. } Ath-Thawri reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Verily, Allah elevates the ranks of the believers' offspring to rank of their parents, even though the latter have not performed as well as the former, so that the eyes of the parents are comforted." Ibn 'Abbas then recited this Ayah, ik is. iAnd those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith, - to them shall We join their offspring, and We shall not decrease the reward of their deeds in anything. } [1] Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this statement from Sufyan Ath-Thawri from Ibn 'Abbas . 121 Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah's statement, rf- frii* (4Pj P iAnd those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith, - to them shall We join their offspring. } saying, "They are the offspring of the believers who died on the faith. If the ranks of their parents are higher than their ranks, they will be joined with their parents. No part of the reward their parents received for their good deeds will be reduced for them." 'Abdullah, son of Imam Ahmad, recorded that 'Ali said, "Khadijah asked the Prophet sg about two of her children who died during the time of Jahiliyyah, and the Messenger of Allah Sg said; Tafsir Ath-Thawri 283 At-Tabari 22:467.

«77iei/ are both in the Fire. When he saw sadness on her face, he said, «If you saw their dwelling place, you would hate them. She said, 'O Allah's Messenger! What about my children with you.' He said, *They are in Paradise.» The Messenger of Allah jg said, «Verily, the believers and their offspring will dwell in Paradise, while the idolators and their offspring will dwell in the Hellfire. The Prophet% then recited the Ayah, iAnd those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith...yW Certainly, it is Allah's grace and favor that He grants the children this blessing because of the good deeds of their parents. He also grants His favor to parents on account of their offspring invoking Allah for them. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, * t ' c d vij LuzJ I JujdJ isrjJ.Jl Sil jl » «*lu hjj) «Verily , Allah shall elevate the grade of a righteous servant in Paradise, who will ask, "O Lord! How did I earn this?" Allah will reply, "Through your son's invoking Me to forgive HI Ahmad 1 : 135 . This is a weak Hadith according to the majority of the scholars

you.»m This Hadith has an authentic chain of narration, but it was not recorded in the Sahih this way. However, there is a witnessing narration for it in Sahih Muslim, from the Hadith of Abu Hurayrah, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said. l Ai p-lp iZj aJLLp ^1 oU liU @aJ JkPJj £lJU» jJ “^Vfien the Son of Adam dies, his record of deeds will cease except in three cases : an ongoing charity, knowledge that people are benefiting from and a righteous son who invokes Allah for /iwi .»|21 Allah is Just with the Sinners Allah the Exalted said, iEvery person is a pledgefor that which he has earned.} After Allah mentioned His favor of elevating the offspring to the ranks of their parents, even though the deeds of the former did not qualify them, He affirmed His fairness in that, He does not punish anyone for the mistakes of others, CfX tc iEvery person is a pledgefor that which he has earned.} Therefore, every person will be responsible for his actions. No sin committed by others shall ever be added to one’s load, even if committed by his or her parents or offspring. Allah the Exalted said, i ‘y’-r 4 ^ ‘iJA, Uj } iEvery person is a pledge for what he has earned, except those on the Right. In Gardens, they will ask one another about the criminals. 74:38-41) Ahmad 2:509. Muslim 3 :1255.

Description oftheKhamrofParadiseand the Delight of its Dwellers Allah said, iff^Jr^ . & j dj ¥ 4And We shall provide them with fruit and meat such as they desire.\$ meaning, *We shall provide them with various types and kinds of fruits and meat, whatever they wish for and desire,’ 4d?£ iThere they shall passfrom hand to hand a cup,\$ meaning, of wine, according to Ad-Dahhak, idf% ^ ifreefrom any Laghw, andfreefrom Ta’tchim> meaning, when they drink, they do not say any idle, vain words or utter dirty, sinful speech like the drunken people in this life do. Ibn ‘Abbas said that Laghw means “falsehood’ while Ta’tchim means lying’. Mujahid said, “They do not curse each other nor sin.” Qatadah said, “These were the consequences of drinking in this life, and Shaytan helped in this regard. Allah purified the wine of the Hereafter from the ills and harm caused by the wine of this life.”² Therefore, Allah has purified the wine of the Hereafter from causing headaches, stomachaches and intoxication like the wine ofthis life. Allah stated that wine ofthe Hereafter shall not cause those who drink it to utter false, vain words that carry no benefit, full of foolishness and evil. Allah also described the wine of the Hereafter as beautiful in appearance, tasty and fruitful, iWhite, delicious to the drinkers . Neither will they have Chawl from that nor will they suffer intoxication therefrom.\$(37:46- 47) and, At-Jabari :22 : 474 ,2) At-Tabari 22:474.

292 Tafstr Ibn Kathir X,?, X)^ oyu-M Hy {Wherefrom they will get neither nay aching of the head nor any intoxication.>(56: 19) Allah the Exalted said here, % fe >i x iir^ sfrfr} {There they shall pass from hand to hand a (wine) cup, free from any Laghw, andfreefrom sin> Allah said. 4And there will go round boy-servants of theirs to serve them as if they were preserved pearls. This is a description of the servants and aids, the believers will have in Paradise. Their servants will be beautiful, graceful in appearance, clean and neat as well-preserved pearls, "/Pi {Immortal boys will go around them with cups, and jugs, and a glass offlowing wine.>(56:17-18) Allah the Exalted said, Jf*i & j*""! jji»^ {And some ofthem draw near to others, questioning.} meaning, the believers will draw near to each other talking and remembering their actions and conditions in this life, just as people in this life talk while drinking, especially when they become intoxicated. {Saying: “Aforetime, we were afraid in the midst of our families.”} meaning, ‘in the life of world and in the midst of our families, we were afraid of our Lord and fearful of His torment and punishment,’

Jr *?^ / A .< * > <* * >VSC'% , * ,1 >>#- *>.trv i-Vr-r^tc^ ;.cS'y 0jUj^J? *.i£.it?i:1 •* "" f>> %<?*/
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 lli iii i%-t^ 4So Allah has been gracious to us, and has saved us from the tor- ment of the Fire. meaning,
 'He has granted us a favor and saved us from what we feared,' 4*>wi XI o; £-£=> iVerily, We used to
 invoke Him before. meaning, *we used to invoke Him with sub- mission and humility, and He accepted
 our invocation and gave us what we wished,' S' y xy iVerily, He is the Most Subtle, the Most Merciful.
 *^i j*3-* ^ 'V Vj tLj c > oi' u j? j>jj^ }-y) % \$ \X% \$ f&i&' \>S> oj, YiX*i ^ J? *Ay •jJjA \$
 »js>vy'd» 429. Therefore, remind. By the grace of Allah, you are neither a Kahin nor a madman. 430.
 Or do they say: "A poet! We awaitfor him some calamity by time!" 431 . Say : "Wait! I am with you
 among those who wait!"} 432. Or do their minds command them this or are they people transgressing
 all bounds?} 433. Or do they say: "He has forged it?" Nay! They believe

not!} 434. Let them then produce a recitation like unto it if they are truthful.} Absolving the Prophet
 sfe; of the False Accusations the Idolators made against Him Allah the Exalted commands His
 Messenger jg to convey His Message to His servants and remind them of His revelation that has been
 sent down to him. Next, Allah refutes the false accusations that the liars and sinners accused the Prophet
 jg of, iTherefore, remind. By the grace of Allah, you are neither a Kdhin nor a madman . Allah says,
 "by the grace of Allah, you, O Muhammad, are not a Kdhin, as the ignorant Quraysh idolators ciaim.' A
 Kdhin is the soothsayer who receives information from the Jinns that the Jinns are able to eavesdrop on
 news from heaven, 4& 4nor a madman^ whom Shaytan has possessed with insanity. Allah the Exalted
 said, while chastising the pagans for uttering false statements about the Prophet jg, vj> *#j ojyj '^} 40r
 do they say "A poet! We await for him some calamity by time!"} They said, *We await a disaster to
 strike him, for example, death. We will be patient with him until death comes to him and ive, thus, get
 rid of his bother and from his Message.' Allah the Exalted said, 4Say : "Wait! 1 am with you among
 those who wait!"} 'wait and I too will wait with you, and you will come to know to whom the good end
 and triumph shall be granted in this life and the Hereafter.' Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that
 'Abdullah bin Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When the Quraysh gathered in
 the DarAn-Nadwah (their meeting place) to

discuss the matter of the Prophet, one ofthem said, 'Jail him in chains. Then we will wait and in time, a
 calamity will strike him; he will diejust as the poets before him died, such as Zuhayr and An-Nabighah,
 for he is a poet just like them.' Allah the Exalted said in response to their statement, jjeli ojLjL jfy iOr do
 they say : "A poet! We await for him some calamity by time!"}''* I Allah the Exalted said, fCxs yjk ft
 iOr do their minds command them this}, 'do their minds command them to tell these lies against you (O
 Muhammad), even though they know in their hearts that they are untrue and false,' ^ ft ior are they
 people transgressing all bounds?} 'surely, they are misguided, stubborn and unjust people, and this is
 why they say what they say about you (O Muhammad).' Allah the Exalted said, iOr do they say: "He
 has forged it?"} They said, "he has forged this Qur'an and brought it from his own.' Allah the Exalted
 responded to them, iNay! They believe not!}, meaning, their disbelief drives them to utter these
 statements, %£» yi£-,\$2*^ iLet them then produce a recitation like unto it if they are truthful.}

meaning, if they are truthful in their statement that I 1 ' At-Jabari 22:479, Sirah Ibn Hisham 1:480-482, and it is an unauthentic narration. For the complete story see volume four, the

Tafsir of Surat Al-Anfdl (8 :30)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5579–5588]

296 Tafslr Ibn KathJr Muhammad has forged this Qur'an and brought it of his own, then let them produce something similar to what he has brought forth, as in this Qur'an! And even if they combine their strength to that of the people of the earth, Jinns and mankind alike, they will never produce something like the Qur'an, or ten Surahs like it, or even one Surah! Jf 1jJyij ^ (U }ur j* 0 (ft*/-- yAA-i "X \ d filojJXX pi f] Jjj fi f' fj~ & (4* £3 iiS^j f' '(\$3j ££\$ 2 !Tp;^i A' ^ ^ ^ A si5 (o' fi f *» pS 4jj~ & A'xx 435. Or were they created by nothing? Or were they themselves the creators?} 436. Or did they create the heavens and the earth? Nay, but they have no firm belief. 437. Or are with them the treasures of your Lord? Or are they the tyrants with the authority to do as they like?} 438. Or have they a stairway (to heaven), by means of which they listen? Then let their listener produce some manifest proof.} 439. Or has He only daughters and you have sons?} 440. Or is it that you ask a wage from them so that they are burdened with a load of debt?} 441. Or that the Unseen is with them, and they borrow it down?} 442. Or do they intend a plot? But those who disbelieve are themselves plotted against!} 443. Or have they a god other than Allah? Glorified be Allah from all that they ascribe as partners Affirming Tawhîd and annulling the Plots of the Idolaters This is the position where Tawhîd of Allah's Lordship and Divinity are affirmed. Allah the Exalted said,

y / yy "i v » • y y (*-» fi oi 'ijf- iOr were they created by nothing? Or were they themselves the creators? Allah asks them, were they created without a maker or did they create themselves? Neither is true. Allah is the One Who created them and brought them into existence after they were nothing. Al-Bukhari recorded that Jubayr bin Mut'im said, "I heard the Prophet s.g. recite Surat At-Tur in Al-Maghrib prayer and when he reached this Ayah, ^ Jf JyV'j \ySs- ^ jt iOr were they created by nothing? Or were they themselves the creators? Or did they create the heavens and the earth? Nay, but they have no firm belief. Or are with them the treasures of your Lord? Or are they the tyrants with the authority to do as they like?\$, I felt my heart would fly away."111 This Hadith is collected in the Two Sahihis using various chains of narration.*2 * Jubayr bin Mut'im went to the Messenger of Allah s.g. after the battle of Badr to ransom the captured idolaters . At that time, he was still an idolater. Hearing the Prophet ?\$ recite this Ayah was one of the reasons that he later embraced Islam. Allah the Exalted said, iOr did they create the heavens and the earth? Nay, but they have no firm belief. meaning, Allah is censuring the idolaters for their idolatry, while asking them if they created the heavens and earth. They knew that Allah Alone is the Creator without partners with Him. However, they fell into idolatry because they had no firm belief, iOr are with them the treasures of your Lord? Or are they the 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :469 121 Fath Al-Bari 2 :289 , 6 :194 and 7 :375 and Muslim 3 :338 and 339

298 Tafstr Ibn Kathir tyrants with the authority to do as they like?} meanings, do they have the authority to do whatever they will in His kingdom? Do they hold the keys to His treasures in their hands? • ior are they the tyrants with the authority to do as they like?} meanings, are they the tyrants who would hold the creation to account? Never, Allah the Exalted and Most Honored is the Only King

and Owner of the existence and He does what He wills. Allah the Exalted said, ikW ^ iOr have they a stairway, by means of which they listen.} . meaning, do they have a stairway to heaven (to the place where the angels are), dzi} iThen let their listener produce some manifest proof.} meaning, let their listener produce evidence to the truth of their actions' and statements. They will never be able to do so and therefore, they have nothing and have no evidence for their stance. Allah admonishes them regarding their claim that He has daughters and that the angels are females! The pagans chose for themselves male offspring and preferred them instead of females, and when one of them would be brought the good news of a daughter being bom, his face would turn dark on. account of his suppressed anger! Yet, they made the angels Allah's daughters and worshipped them besides Allah, pj^ *& iOr has He only daughters and you have sons?} Allah sends a strong warning and stem admonition to them in this Ayah and a sure promise. Allah said, 4# -\} 40r is it that you ask a wage from them} meaning, 'as a remuneration for your preaching Allah's Message to them? Nay,

299Surah 52. At-Tur (44-49) (Part-27) you, do not ask them for a wage,' iso that they are burdened with a load of debt?}, meaning, for in this situation, one will complain of the least bothersome thing and feel it difficult and burdensome for him, jM v4' f'P iOr that the Unseen is with them, and they write it down?} means, they do not have knowledge of the Unseen, for none in the heavens or earth knows the Unseen except Allah, 4*sQ G3f 'ojx iOr do they intend a plot? But those ivho disbelieve are themselves plotted against!} Allah the Exalted is asking, 'Do these people who utter such statements about the Messenger and his religion seek to deceive the people and plot against the Messenger and his Companions? If they do, then let them know that their plots will only harm them. Therefore, they are being plotted against rather than being the plotters!' iOr have they a god other than Allah? Glorified be Allah from all that they ascribe as partners (to Him).} This Ayah contains harsh refutation directed at the idolators for worshipping the idols and calling upon rivals along with Alfah. Allah next glorifies His Most Honorable Self from what they ascribe to Him, their lies and idolatry, 4&S &\$1^} iGlorified be Allah from all that they ascribe as partners (to Him).} Aj ,/jji V*"- jurti £ liX hot <4\$ jjj Wj |yAi dLj fir* jA. lifjoylA lily fA, £y-J *4 jp J^A) ^ >4^

444. And if they were to see a piece of the heaven falling dawn, they would say: "Clouds gathered in heaps!"} 445. So leave them alone till they meet their Day, in which they will sink into afainting (with horror).} 446. The Day when their plotting shall not avail them at all, nor will they be helped.} 447. And verily, for those who do wrong, there is another punishment before this; but tmost ofthem knmo not.} 448. So wait patiently for the decision ofyour Lord, for verily, you are under Our Eyes; and glorify the praises of your Lord when you get up.} 449. And in the nighttime also glorify His praises and at the setting of the stars.} The Stubbornness ofthe Idolators; Their Punishment Allah the Exalted reaffirms the stubbornness of the idolators and their ignorance ofwhat goes around them, 4^>C LIX ijy_ 4And if they were to see a piece of the heaven falling doivn,} meaning, on them as punishment, they would not believe it is coming their way, saying that, these are layers of clouds on top of each other. Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat, £ J?&4£& :o»; a ySS ft £3 %} 4And even if We opened to them a gate from the heaven and they were to keep on ascending thereto (all day long), they ivould surely say (in the evening): "Our eyes have been dazzled. Nay, we are a people bewitched.">(15: 14-15) Allah the Exalted said, 4p>y*} 4So leave them alone}, 'O Muhammad,' AC » > '> \ 4till they meet their Day, in which they will sink into a

302 Surah 52. At-Tur (44-49) (Part-27) fainting.} on the Day of Resurrection, ££ JL ^ '£} 4 The Day when their plotting shall not avail them at all,} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, their deceit and plots they planned in this life shall not help them in the least, inor will they be helped.} Allah the Exalted said, Oji Ujc IjJii isji} } And verily, for those who do wrong, there is another punishment before this;} meaning, that of being the torment in this world. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, //•/ /> > * < JjJ' JjJ» i And verily, We will make them taste of the near torment prior to the supreme torment (in the Hereafter), in order that they may return.}(32:21) Allah said; *jaw &;} ibut most of them know not.} meaning, We will torment them in the life of the world and test them with various hardships, so that they might go back and repent. However, they do not understand what is happening to them or why, because when the torment is removed, they revert to committing the worst of what they used to do before.' A Hadlth states that, Ordering the Prophet^ to have Patience and to glorify Allah Allah the Exalted said, 4 So wait patiently for the decision of your Lord, for verily, you are under Our Eyes;} meaning, "be patient in the face of their annoyance and do not be concerned about it, for you are under Our Eyes and

Protection, and We will surely protect you from the people,' i and glorify the praises of your Lord when you get up.\$ Ad-Dahhak said, "Meaning to stand for the Salah (and say): "Glorious are You and with Your praise. Hallowed be Your Name, Exalted be Your majesty, and there is no God (worthy of worship) except You." In his Sahth, Muslim recorded that Umar used to recite this supplication when he began Saldh.' 2 ' Ahmad and the Sunan compilers recorded this Hadith from Abu Said and other Companions, who stated that the Prophet used to say that.* 3 * Abu Al-Jawza' commented on the Ayah; 4 ^ o*; 4 and glorify the praises of your Lord when you get up.\$> "From your sleep, from your bed." 14' And this is the view chosen by Ibn Jarir. 15' Suporting this view is the Hadith that Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Ubadah bin As-Samit said that the Messenger of Allah si said, i I'jJ-'j Jil VI iil V :JLS jdl Ija jU; Zft ij ,#f 4ij iii vi iij tj jii ^ ft iJj : Jli j\ - 4o : Jll p -jil VI i'J Vj J> ft % * * S» ' * i Z - I X cJLS Li^i jli ^Whoever gets up at night and says : 'La ildha illallah, He is One without partners. For Him is the kingdom and all praise is due to Him. He has power over all things. Glory be to Allah, and all praise is due to Allah, and La illdha illallah and Allah is Greater. There is neither might nor power except AUSh.' And then says, "O Lord! Forgive me.' Or invokes (Allah), he will be m At-Tabari 22:489. Muslim 1 :299 ' Ahmad 3 :50, Abu Dawud 1 :490, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 2 :47 and 50, An-Nasal, 2 :132 and Ibn Majah 1 :264 and 265 ' Al-Qurtubi 17:79. ,5' At-Tabari 22:488.

303 Surah 52. At-Tiir (44-49) (Part-27) responded to it, and if he intends and performs ablution and prays, his prayer will be accepted .a' 1 ' Al-Bukhari and the Sunan compilers also recorded this Hadith. | 2i Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid commented on the Ayah, JL>K' f V' *'» ••"X mj 'sw i and glorify the praises of your Lord when you get up.} saying, "From every gathering you sit in." Ath-Thawri said that Abu Ishaq narrated that Abu Al-Ahwas said that, i and glorify the praises of your Lord when you get up.} "When a person wants to stand from a gathering, he says: 'Glory be to You, O Allah, and with Your praise.'"" 31 Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet jg said, * p # + * * * * f ' «• * * * * ^ ^ ^ ^ t ^ viljLA—. fjZ jl Jlii jjj <j ij in> yj iJdi i,fj .vSJ! Y! aj y' M j+M ^4jji «iu> ^5 jls u «W?ioeiw sits in a gathering in which he speaks idle excessively, but says before he stands up to depart that gathering, 'Glory be to You O Allah , and with Your praise, I testify that there is no God (worthy of worship) except You, I seek Your forgiveness, and I repent to You.' Then, Allah will forgive him what

he has said in that gatherings This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, and this is his wording, and it was also recorded by An-Nasal in [‘Amal\ Al-Yawm wal- Laylah.W At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Saftfh.” It was also recorded by Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak, and he said, “Its chain meets the criteria of Muslim.”*51 Ahmad 5:313. 121 Fath Al-Bari 3 :47 , Abu Dawud 5 :305 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :359 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :215 and Ibn Majah 2 :1276. Al-Qurtubi 17:78. Tuhfat Al-Ahu>adhi 9 :392 and An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :105 151 Al-Hakim, 1:536.

Allah the Exalted said; iAnd in the nighttime also glorify His praises meaning remember and worship Allah by reciting the Qur’an and praying at night. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, iAnd in some of the night, offer Tahajjud in it as an additional (prayer) for you. It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmtid.\$>(17:79) Allah said; iand at the setting of the stars. is in reference to the two voluntary Rak'ahs before the Dawn prayer, according to a Hadlth from Ibn ‘Abbas. These two Rak'ahs are an established Sunnah performed before the stars are about to set. 11 ’ It is confirred in the Two Sahihs from ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, who said, “The Prophet was never more regular and particular in offering any voluntary prayer than the two (Sunnah) Rak'ahs of the Fajr prayer. ”*2 * In another narration collected by Muslim, [the Prophet jgg said,] Cjjlj J>d\ tZj&j® «Two (Sunnah) Rak'ahs before Fajr are better than this life and all that in iiV31

Surah 53: An-Najm

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The Tafsir of SuratAn-Najm

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5589–5616]

(Chapter - 53) Which was revealed in Makkah The First Surah in which a Prostration is revealed Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdullah [bin Mas’ud] said, “Surat An-Najm was the first Surah in which a prostration was revealed. The Prophet ﷺ (recited it in Makkah) and prostrated. Those who were with him did the same, except an old man who took a handful of soil and prostrated on it. Later on, I saw him killed as a disbeliever; he was Umayyah bin Khalaf.”’ Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in several places of his Sahih, as did Muslim, Abu Dawud and An-Nasai, using various chains of narration through Abu Ishaq from ‘Abdullah.¹² In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. “By the star when it goes down 42 . Your companion has neither gone astray nor has he erred.” 43 . Nor does he speak of desire.” 44 . It is only a revelation revealed.} Allah swears the Messenger is True and His Words are a Revelation from Him Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ash-Sha’bi and others stated that the Creator swears by whatever He wills among His creation, but the created only vow by the Creator. Allah said, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :480 121 Fath. Al-Bari 2:641 and 643. 7:202 and 348. Muslim 1 :405. Abu Dawud 2 : 122 and An-Nasai 2 :160

4By the star when it goes down .} Ibn Abi Najih reported that Mujahid said, “The star refers to Pleiades when it sets at Fq/r.”111 Ad-Dahhak said “When the Shayatin are shot with it.” And this Ayah is like Allah’s saying; “A \$!\$-~*!~»~*~>-s^ <So, / swear by the setting of the stars. And verily, that is indeed great oath, if you but know. That is indeed an honorable recitation. In a Book well-guarded. Which none can touch but the pure. A revelation from the Lord of all that existsM56:75-80) Allah said; iYour companion has neither gone astray nor has erred,} This contains the subject of the oath. This part of the Ayah is the witness that the Messenger of Allah jg is sane and a follower of Truth. He is neither led astray, such as in the case of the ignorant who does not proceed on any path with knowledge, nor is he one who erred, such as in the case of the knowledgeable, who knows the Truth, yet deviates from it intentionally to something else. Therefore, Allah exonerated His Messenger and his Message from being similar to the misguided ways of the Christians and the erroneous paths of the Jews, such as knowing the Truth and hiding it, while abiding by falsehood. Rather, he, may Allah’s peace and blessings be on him, and his glorious Message that Allah has sent him with, are on the perfect straight path, following guidance and what is correct. Muhammad 0,was sent as aMercy for allthat exists;He does not speak ofHis Desire Allah said, 111 At-Tabari 22:495.

307 Surah 53. An-Najm (5-18) (Part-27) iNor does he speak of desire}, asserting that nothing the Prophet jgg utters is of his own desire or wish, ITj >> of ill is only a revelation revealed.}, means, he only conveys to the people what he was commanded to convey, in its entirety without additions or

deletions. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Umamah said that he heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say. « Verily, numbers similar to the two tribes, or one of them, Rab'ah and Mudar, will enter Paradise on account of the intercession of one man, who is not a Prophet. » A man asked, “O Allah’s Messenger! Is not Rab'ah a subtribe of Mudar.” The Prophet ﷺ said, > if . \ S 1Jji ' lx </ said what I said.*111 Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said, “I used to record everything I heard from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ so it would be preserved. The Quraysh discouraged me from this, saying, ‘You record everything you hear from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ , even though he is human and sometimes speaks when he is angry?’ I stopped recording the Hadiths for a while, but later mentioned what they said to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ , who said, N J 7^j>- ! s ^JJ ji , I «Write! By He in Whose Hand is my soul, every word that comes out of me is the Truth .s”*2 ! Abu Dawud also collected this Hadith. [3 ' atf ofc tt £& t* jjlc Ji j' cj£-j \j 111 Ahmad 5:257. 121 Ahmad 2:162. Abu Dawud 4 :60

308 Tafsir Ibn Kathir & h \$£0 % Vm €\$&\$& (p\$ 3? \Cj 2f; 4-VSLE/SO' tjj ciU J* ill oil £> Jy^ll £!j d ,. 5.»^Us £ 45. He /ws been taught by one mighty in power.} 46. Dhu Mirrah then he Istawa.} 47. While he was in the highest part of the horizon , 48. Then he approached and came closer,} 49. And was at a distance of hvo boios' length or less.} 410. So (Allah) revealed to His servant whatever He revealed.} 411. The heart lied not in what he saw.} 412. Will you then dispute with him about what he saw?} 413. And indeed he saw him at a second descent.} 414. Near Sidrat Al-Muntaha.} [1 415. Near it is the Paradise of Abode.} 416. When tlmr covered the lote tree which did cover it!} 417. The sight turned not aside, nor it transgressed beyond the limit.} 418. Indeed he saw of the greatest Signs of his Lord.} The Trustworthy Angel brought Allah’s Revelation to the Trustworthy Messenger Allah the Exalted states that the Message His servant and Messenger Muhammad ﷺ brought to people was taught to him by, 4\$ \ 1^} 4mighty in power}, he is Jibril, peace be upon him, 44^ f 'bMtj <s'i jlfi Jj2 %[] 4Verily, this is the Word a most honorable messenger, owner of power, with (Allah) the Lord of the Throne, obeyed (by the angels) and trustworthy>(81:19-21) Allah said here, Sidrat Al-Muntaha: A lote tree of the utmost boundary over the seventh heaven beyond which none can pass

309 Surah 53. Ati-Najm (5-18) (Part-27) iis, Adhu Mirrah}, meaning, he is mighty in power, according to Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Ibn Zayd.' ' In an authentic Hadith from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar and Abu Hurayrah, the Prophet ﷺ said, Yj*. J*-- «Charity is not allowed for a rich person nor Dhu Mirrah (a strong person) of sound mind and body .»' ' Allah said; A&&> then he Istawa (rose).} this refers to the angel Jibril, according to Al-Hasan, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ar-Rabi' bin Anas,131 iWhile he was in the highest part of the horizon .} meaning, Jibril rose to the highest part of the horizon, according to ‘Ikrimah and several others; ‘Ikrimah said, “The highest horizon where the morning comes from.” Mujahid said, “It is (the place of) sunrise.”41 Qatadah said, “That from which the day comes.”5’ Ibn Zayd and several others said similarly. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abdullah bin Mas‘ud said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ saw Jibril in his original shape having six hundred wings, each wing filling the side of the horizon, with a colorful array, and pearls and rubies falling from each wing as much as only Allah knows.”6 ' Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abbas said, “The Prophet asked Jibril to appear himself to him in his original shape and Jibril said to him, ‘Invoke your Lord.’ The Prophet m At-Tabari 22 :499 and Al-Qurtubi 17 :85. '2 Abu Dawud 2 : 286 and An-Nasat, 5 :99. ' At-Tabari 22:501. Al-Qurtubi 17:88. ' At-Tabari 22 :501 , and Ahmad 1 :460.

Ahmad 1 :395 and 412. Al-Bukhfi and Muslim recorded the same without the mention of pearls and rubies. See the narration recorded by Ahmad 1 :460, which is similar.

M invoked his Lord the Exalted and Most Honored, and a great huge figure appeared to him from the east and kept rising and spreading. When the Prophet \$jg saw Jibrfl in his original shape, he was knocked unconscious. Jibril came down and revived the Prophet igj and wiped the saliva off of his cheeks.”¹¹¹ Only Ahmad collected this Haddth. Meaning of Mat a distance oftwo bows' length or less” Allah’s statement, jf ijli 4And was at a distance oftwo bows' length or less means, Jibril came closer to Muhammad when Jibril was descending to him on earth. At that time, the distance between them became only two bow lengths, when the bows are extended to full length, according to Mujahid and Qatadah.¹²¹ It was said that the meaning here is the distance between the bow’s string and its wood center. Allah’s statement, 4\$ 4or less^ indicates that the distance was as only as far described, not more. This type of usage is found in several instances in the Qur’an, such as, 4~ i’ji* & li dlSi 4Then, after that, your hearts were hardened and became as stones or even worse in hardness.>(2:74) The Ayah says that their hearts became not softer than rocks, but as hard and difficult as rocks, and more. There is a similar Ayah, oil jl£& jtif ifear men as they fear Allah or even more.}{4:77), and Allah’s statement, 111 Ahmad 1:322. With Al-Bukhari and Muslim there are narrations from ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that mention some of this information * At-Jabari 22:503 and 'Abdur-Razzaq 3 :250.

'} 531* ^ji} iAnd We sent him to hundred thousand (people) or even more.}(37:147), indicating that they were not less than a hundred thousand, but thatamount or more. Therefore, this verifies the facts mentioned, leavingnodoubt ormeans ofrefute. Similarly, Allah said, 0&} iAnd was at a distance of two bow lengths or less.} We stated before that it was Jibril who came down near the Prophet jg, according to ‘A’ishah, the Mother of the faithful, ‘Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Abu Dharr and Abu Hurayrah. * We will mention their statements about this soon afterwards, Allah willing. Ibn Jarir recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas*ud said about this Ayah, iAnd was at a distance oftwo bow lengths or less.} “Allah's Messenger slg said, Q oJlJS </ saw fibril; he had six hundred wings . Al-Bukhari recorded that Talq bin Ghannam said that Za'idah said that Ash-Shaybani said, “1 asked Zirr about the Ayah, £ JI j* «C>li J^»} iAnd was at a distance of two bow lengths or less. So (Allah) revealed to His servant whatever He revealed.} Zirr said, “Abdullah narrated to us that Muhammad jg saw Jibril having six hundred wings.”*³¹ Allah’s statement, JI iSo he revealed to His servant whatever He revealed.} 111 At-Tabari 22:504. At-Tabari 22:503. 131 FathAl-Bdri 8:476.

means, Jibril conveyed to Allah’s servant Muhammad jg whatever he conveyed. Or, the meaning here could be: Allah revealed to His servant Muhammad jg whatever He revealed through Jibril. Both meanings are correct. Said bin Jubayr said about Allah’s statement, 4Rife’S tl -.jIc J] iSo He revealed to His servant whatever He revealed. “Allah revealed to him, j)JU fi\ \$ iDid He notfind you an orphan . \$(93:6), and, 4And have We «of raised high yourfame (94 :4) ”*¹ Someone else said, “Allah revealed to the Prophet sg that the Prophets will not enter Paradise until he enters it first, and the nations will not enter it until his Ummah enters it first.” Did the Prophet sg see His Lord during the Night of Isra’? Allah said next, 4The heart lied not in what he saw. Will you then dispute with him about what he saw? \$ Muslim recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas about: iThe heart lied not in what he saw\$, and, iAnd indeed he saw him at a second descent. ^ “He saw Allah twice in his heart.”*² Simak reported a similar from

'Ikrimah from Ibn 'Abbas.*31 Abu Salih, As-Suddi and Al-Qurtubi 17:52. Muslim 1 :158. Aj-Tabari 22 :507

323 Surah 53. An-Naim (5-18) (Part-27) several others said similarly that the Prophet gg saw Allah twice in his heart. Masruq said, "I went to 'A'ishah and asked her, 'Did Muhammad sg see his Lord?' She said, *You said something that caused my hair to rise! I said, 'Behold!' and recited this Ayah, indeed he saw of the greatest signs of his Lord." She said, 'Where did your mind wander? It was Jibril. Whoever says to you that Muhammad jg saw his Lord, or hid any part of what he was commanded (i.e., Allah's Message), or knew any of the five things which only Allah knows, \uj icUilf pic iVerihj, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain...}(3 1:34), Then he invents a great lie against Allah! The Prophet jg only saw Jibril twice, in his original shape, once near Sidrat Al- Muntaha and another time in Ajyad (in Makkah) while Jibril had six hundred wings that covered the horizon.'"*21 Muslim recorded that Abu Dharr said, "I asked the Messenger of Allah 3g, 'Have you seen your Lord?' He said, «r,i Jf jji "How can I see Him since there was a light?"* In smother narration,

the Prophet said, ® I jy "2 only saw a light . »*3 Allah's statement, At-Tabari 22:508. * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:167. The authentic narrations recorded by Muslim (and similarly with Al-Bukhari), nos. 174, and 177 do not particularly mention seeing Jibril at the Sidrah, as is inferred by the Ayah, and Ibn Mas*Od's narration from 'Asim which follows. * Muslim 1 :161 N,

4 And indeed he saw him at a second descent. Near Sidrat Al- Muntaha. Near it is the Paradise of Abode}, This is the second time the Messenger of Allah sg saw Jibril in the shape that Allah created him; it was during the Night of Isra'. We mentioned the various Hadiths about the Night of Isra' in the beginning of Surat Al-Isra'. Therefore, there is no need to repeat them here. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Mas"ad commented: 4 And indeed he saw him at a second descent. Near Sidrat Al- Muntaha.} "The Messenger of Allah said, «J saw Jibril while he had six hundred wings and a colorful array of pearls and rubies falling from the feathers of his wings,n"*1 This bfadith has a good, strong chain of narration. Ahmad also recorded that 'Abdullah [Ibn MasTid] said, "The Messenger of Allah saw Jibril in his original shape while Jibril had six hundred wings, each wing covering the side of the horizon. From his wings, precious stones were dropping of which only Allah has knowledge."*21 This Hadith has a good chain of narration. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas*ud said, "The Messenger of Allah jjjg said, «/ saw Jibril over Sidrat Al-Muntaha while he had six hundred wingsy One of the subnarrators of the Hadith asked 'Asim about Jibril's wings and 'Asim refused to elaborate. So some of his companions were asked and one of them said, "Each wing was covering what is between the east and the west."*3 * This ** Ahmad 1 :460. * Ahmad 1 :355 131 Ahmad 1 :407.

315 Surah 53. An-Naim (5-18) (Part-27) Hadith has a good chain of narration. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Mas'Od said that Allah's Messenger jg said: «5aJi jlii Jjj'f. 'fibril came to me wearing green with pearls hanging down. This Hadith has a good chain of narration. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Amir said that Masruq asked 'A'ishah, "O Mother of the faithful, has Muhammad jg seen his Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored?" She said, "Glorious is Allah! My hair is standing on end because of what you said. Three matters, if one tells you about any of them, will have lied. Whoever tells you that Muhammad has seen his Lord, will have lied." She then recited these two Ayat, iNo vision can grasp

Him, but He grasps all vision. (6:103), and, & ji ' } \ i£f c& ilt is not given to any human being that Allah should speak to him unless (it be) by revelation, or from behind a veil. (42:51) She went one, "And whoever tells you that Muhammad jg knew what the morrow will bring, will have uttered a lie." She then recited, 4 £ —lyjj icLSif pc ixc -it iVerily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. (31:34) 'A'ishah said, "And whoever tells you that Muhammad jg has hidden any part of the Message will have lied," and she then recited this Ayah, 40 Messenger proclaim which has been sent down to you from your Lord. (5:67). She went one, "However, he saw Jibril twice in his original

316 Tafslr Ibn Kathir shape." Imam Ahmad also recorded that Masruq said, "I asked 'A'ishah, 'Did not Allah say, i Xj s&}} iAtid indeed he saw him in the clear horizon. (81:23), and, iAnd indeed he saiv him at a second descent?'" She said, 'I was the first among this Ummah to ask Allah's Messenger jg about it. He said, illj UJIB «That was fibril.* He only saw him twice in his actual and real figure. He saw JibrH descend from heaven to earth and was so huge that he covered the whole horizon between the sky and earth.®'''*21 This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs via Ash- Shahi.131 Angels, Light and colors covered SidratAl-Muntaha Allah said, t \} iWhen that covered the lote tree which did cover it!} We mentioned before, in the Hadiths about Al-Isra' that the angels, Allah's Light, and spectacular colors covered the Sidrah. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "When the Messenger of Allah was taken on the Isra' journey, he ascended to Sidrat Al-Muntaha, which is in the seventh heaven. There everything terminates that ascends from the earth and is held there, and terminates everything that descends from above it is held there, iWhen that covered the lote tree which did cover it!} 111 Ahmad 6:49, similar recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim, see below. 121 Ahmad 6 : 241 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :472 and Muslim 1 :359

377Surah 53. An-Najm (5-18) (Part-27) He said, "Golden butterflies. The Messenger of Allah ^ was given three things: He was given the five prayers, he was given the concluding verses of Surat Al-Baqarah (2:284-286), and remission of serious sins for those among his Ummah who do not associate anything with Allah."111 Muslim collected this HadlthJ21 Allah's statement, s jsjt g c} iThe sight turned not aside, nor it transgressed beyond the limits indicates that the Prophet's sight did not turn right or left, according to 'Ibn 'Abbas,131 cf} inor it transgressed beyond the limit.} not exceeding what has been ordained for it. This is a tremendous quality that demonstrates the Prophet's firm obedience to Allah, because he only did what was commanded and did ask beyond what he was given. Allah's statement, ilndeed he saw of the greatest signs of his Lord.} another Ayah, ity: %ji} is similar to iln order that We might show him ofOur Ayat. (17:1), meaning, signs that testify to Allah's might and greatness. Relying on these two Ayat, some scholars of Ahl us-Sunnah said that the Prophet did not see Allah during the Isra' journey, because Allah said, & 3} ^Indeed he saw of the greatest signs ofhis Lord.} They said that, had the Prophet jg seen his Lord, Allah would have conveyed this news and the Prophet jg would have Ahmad 1 :422. 121 Muslim 1 :157. Af-Tabari 22:521.

«n ~§03»i- 'mmm sip^ 0&& !>l0ZsjXtf narrated it to the people. &J <£&% , -J !\$* P f^S>Vi a*j.iliT tii 4 \$:^iiVf iij 'Ai Ji 5i \$»*-? \$ u jftcj fal !>&' oy^i qj ,^»£ u; ^1 > -, '*.'i' '-f.tK '•: ." ^U- -UJj j » »_£>4- > y t ipt } « i^"> & tj\$& tjz v 4>^jji ^^ o' J5 SSfc ill^ Sj VL 6a £ESa 429. Have you then considered Al-Ldt, and Al-'Uzza.} 420. And Manat, the other third?} Is itfor you the males andfor Him

the females?} 422. That indeed is a division most unfair!} 423. They are but names which you have named - you and your fathers - for which Allah has sent down no authority. They follow but a guess and that which they themselves desire, whereas there has surely come to them the guidance from their Lord!} 424. Or shall man have what he wishes?} 425. But to Allah belongs the last (Hereafter) and the first (the world).} 426. And there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing, except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.}

319 Surah 53. An-Naim (19-26) (Part-27) Refuting Idolatry, Al-Lat and Al-'Uzza Allah the Exalted rebukes the idolators for worshipping idols and taking rivals to Him. They built houses for their idols to resemble the Ka'bah built by Prophet Ibrahim, Allah's Khalil. iHave you then considered Al-Lat,> Al-Lat was a white stone with inscriptions on. There was a house built around Al-Lat in At-Ta'if with curtains, servants and a sacred courtyard around it. The people of At-Ta'if, the tribe of Thaqif and their allies, worshipped Al-Lat. They would boast to Arabs, except the Quraysh, that they had Al-Lat. Ibn Jarir said, "They derived Al-Lat's name from Allah's Name, and made it feminine. Allah is far removed from what they ascribe to Him. It was reported that Al-Lat is pronounced Al-Lat because, according to 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas, Mujahid, and Ar-Rabf bin Anas, Al-Lat was a man who used to mix Sawlq (a kind of barley mash) with water for the pilgrims during the time of Jahiliyyah. When he died, they remained next to his grave and worshipped him." Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4Al-Lat, and Al-'Uzza "Al-Lat was a man who used to mix Sawiq for the pilgrims."121 Ibn Jarir said, "They also derived the name for their idol Al-'Uzza from Allah's Name Al-'Aziz. Al-'Uzza was a tree on which the idolators placed a monument and curtains, in the area of Nakhlah, between Makkah and At-Ta'if. The Quraysh revered Al-'Uzza."131 During the battle of Uhud, Abu Sufyan said, "We have Al-'Uzza, but you do not have Al-'Uzza." Allah's Messenger replied, 'j'y ij Jil :JJ» "Say, "Allah is Our Supporter, but you have no support."*1' At-Tabari 22:523. FathAl-Bari 8:478. At-Tabari 22:523. FathAl-Bari 6:188.

320 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Manat was another idol in the area of Mushallal near Qudayd, between Makkah and Al-Madlnah. The tribes of Khuza'ah, Aws and Khazraj used to revere Manat during the time of Jahiliyyah. They used to announce Hajj to the Ka'bah from next to Manat. Al-Bukhari collected a statement from 'A'ishah with this meaning. 111 There were other idols in the Arabian Peninsula that the Arabs revered just as they revered the Ka'bah, besides the three idols that Allah mentioned in His Glorious Book. Allah mentioned these three here because they were more famous than the others. An-Nasal recorded that Abu At-Tufayl said, "When the Messenger of Allah jg conquered Makkah, he sent Khalid bin Al-Walld to the area of Nakhlah where the idol of Al-'Uzza was erected on three trees of a forest. Khalid cut the three trees and approached the house built around it and destroyed it. When he went back to the Prophet and informed him of the story, the Prophet said to him, p iliU "Go back and finish your mission, for you have not finished if.» Khalid went back and when the custodians who were also its servants of Al-TJzza saw him, they started invoking by calling Al-TJzza! When Khalid approached it, he found a naked woman whose hair was untidy and who was throwing sand on her head. Khalid killed her with the sword and went back to the Messenger of Allah sg, who said to him, o! Jib "77wf ivas Al-'Uzza'j'W Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated, "Al-Lat belonged to the tribe of Thaqif in the area of At-Ta'if. Banu Mu'attib were the custodians of Al-Lat and its servants."[3 ' I say that the Prophet jg sent Al-Mughlrah bin Shu"bah and Fath Al-Bari 8 :479 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:474, Abu

Yala no. 902. It is confirmed that Abu At-Tufayl saw the Prophet jg, but not that he heard anything from him 131 Ibn Hisham 1 :87

321 Surah 53. An-Naim (19-26) (Part-27) Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb to destroy Al-Lat. They carried out the Prophet's command and built a Masjid in its place in the city of At-Ta'if. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Manat used to be the idol of the Aws and Khazraj tribes and those who followed their religion in Yathrib (Al-Madlnah). Manat was near the coast, close to the area of Mushallal in Qudayd. The Prophet jg sent Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb or 'Ali bin Abi Talib to demolish it. Ibn Ishaq said that Dhul-Khalasah was the idol of the tribes of Daws, Khath'am and Bajllah, and the Arabs who resided in the area of TabalahJ' I say that Dhul-Khalasah was called the Southern Ka*bah, and the Ka'bah in Makkah was called the Northern Ka'bah. The Messenger of Allah jg sent Jarir bin 'Abdullah Al-Bajall to Dhul-Khalasah and he destroyed it. Ibn Ishaq said that Fals was the idol of Tay' and the neighboring tribes in the Mount of Tay', such as Salma and Ajja. Ibn Hisham said that some scholars of knowledge told him that the Messenger of Allah sg sent 'Ali bin Abi Talib to Fals and he destroyed it and found two swords in its treasure, which the Prophet jg then gave to 'Ali as war spoils. Muhammad bin Ishaq also said that the tribes of Himyar, and Yemen in general, had a house of worship in San'a' called Riyam. He mentioned that there was a black dog in it and that the religious men who went with Tubba' removed it, killed it and demolished the building. Ibn Ishaq said that Ruda' was a structure of Bani RabT'ah bin Ka*b bin Sa'd bin Zayd Manat bin Tamim,*21 which Al-Mustawghir bin Rabi'ah bin Ka*b bin Sa'd demolished after Islam. In Sindad there was Dhul-KaTsatsat, the idol of the tribes of Bakr and Taghlib, the sons of the Wa'il, and also the Iyad tribes. Refuting the Idolators Who appoint Rivals to Allah and claim that the Angels were Females Allah the Exalted said. iHave you then considered Al-Lat, and Al-'Uzza. And Manat, [I * Ibn Hisham 1 :87. Ibn Hisham 1 :89

the other third?}, then Allah said, %\$A p\} 4Is itfor you the males andfor Him thefemales?} Allahasked the idolators, 'doyouchoose female offspring forAllah and give preference toyourselves with the males? Ifyoumade this divisionbetweenyourselvesand the created, itwould be, 4a division most unfair!}' meaning, it would be an unfair and unjust division. How is it then that you make this division between you and Allah, even though this would be foolish and unjust, ifyou made it between yourselves and others?' Allah the Exalted refutes such innovated lies, falsehood and atheism they invented through worshipping the idols and callingthem gods, i&Cjp •SA Jt& 4They are but names which you have named - you and your fathers} ofyour own desire, M £ 'Jit 'Sj\ '£} 4for which Allah lias sent down no authority.} meaning, proof, opt 4They folloiv but a guess and that which they themselves desire,} they have no proof, except their trust in their forefathers who took this false path in the past, as well as, their lusts and desires to become leaders, and thereby gain honor and reverence for their forefathers, -Hj} 4ivhereas there has surely come to them the guidancefrom their Lord!}, meaning, Allah has sent them Messengers with the clear truth and unequivocal evidence. However, they did not adhere to or follow the guidance that came to them through the Prophets.

Wishful Thinking does not earnOne Righteousness Allah the Exalted said, ft iOr shall watt have what he wishes?}, asserting that not everyone gets the goodness that he wishes, ilt will not be in accordance with desires (of Muslims), nor those of the People of Scripture.}{4:123) Allah says, not everyone who claims to be guided is truly guided, and not everyone gets what he wishes for himself. Imam Ahmad

recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, $\text{اَلْاَوَّلُ لِمَنْ يَرْغُوْهُ شَيْءٌ}$ When one of you wishes for something, let him be careful with what he wishes for, because he does not know what part of his wish will be written for him. Only Ahmad collected this Hadith. Allah's statement, $\text{وَالْاٰخِرُ لِمَنْ يَشَاءُ اللّٰهُ}$ But to Allah belongs the last and the first.} meaning, all matters belong to Allah and He is the King and Owner of this world and the Hereafter, Who does what He will in both lives. Whatever He wills, occurs and whatever He does not will, never occurs. No Intercession except with Allah's Leave. Allah said, $\text{وَلَا يَنْفَعُ الشَّاكِرِيْنَ اِلَّا مَنْ اَمَرَ}$ And there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.} As He said; *** Ahmad 2 :357. There is a slight deficiency in its chain of narrators.

Who is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission? (2:255) and, $\text{وَلَا يَنْفَعُ الشَّاكِرِيْنَ اِلَّا مَنْ اَمَرَ}$ intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits. (34:23) 'If this is the case with the angels who are close to Him, how can you, O ignorant ones, hope for Allah to grant you the intercession of the idols and rivals you worship with Him without having His permission or any divine legislation permitting you to worship them?' Rather, Allah has forbidden idol worshipping by the tongues of all of His Messengers and He revealed this prohibition in all of His Books. $\text{وَلَا يَنْفَعُ الشَّاكِرِيْنَ اِلَّا مَنْ اَمَرَ}$ in -ft (& C-i iSCiii' isri'S. ^ is?' •Jtpiti J j 3j kjfi if 3y iy if Cr! jA 't •>£)' j*i **1^ - it j-> oft 3“ Xf o* •Ittj jV'Gjji V *" Af •• V \ !iXi Jjil li O'? <-^i II r>^V _e. , C ill I. Colt hr&&. 00^C\^00j^YJ£\30 <27. Verily, those who believe not in the Hereafter, name the angels with female names.} <25. But they have no knowledge thereof. They follow but conjecture, and verily, conjecture is no substitute for the

325 Surah 53. An-Najm (27-30) (Part-27) truth. 429. Therefore withdraw from him who turns away from Our Reminder and desires nothing but the life of this world. 430. That is what they could reach of knowledge. Verily, your Lord is He, Who knows best him who goes astray from His path, and He knows best him who receives guidance. > Refuting the Claim of the Idolators that the Angels are Allah's Daughters Allah the Exalted admonishes the idolators for calling the angels female names and claiming that they are Allah's daughters. Allah is far removed from what they ascribe to Him. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ And they make females the angels, who themselves are servants of the Most Gracious. Did they wish their creation? Their testimony will be recorded, and the will be questioned! (43:9) Allah's statement here, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ But they have no knowledge thereof. meaning, they have no correct knowledge testifying to their statements. What they say is all lies, falsehood, fake and utter atheism, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ They follow but conjecture, and verily, conjecture is no substitute for the truth for meaning, conjecture is of no benefit and never takes the place of truth. In a Hadith recorded in the Sahih, the Messenger of Allah said, $\text{اَلْبُشْرُ اَكْثَرُ الْكُذْبِ}$ Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the most lying speech, » [1! 111 Fath Al-Bari 5 :44

The Necessity of turning away from the People of Misguidance Allah's statement, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ Therefore withdraw from him who turns away from Our Reminder means, stay away from those who turn away from the Truth and shun them, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ and desires nothing but the life of this world. > meaning, whose aim and knowledge are concentrated on this life; this is the goal of those who have no goodness in them, $\text{وَلَا يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَاءُ اِنَّهٗ لَعَلِيْمٌ خَبِيْرٌ}$ That is what they could reach of knowledge.} meaning, seeking this life and striving hard in its affairs is the best knowledge they have acquired. r There is also the reported supplication: $\text{اَللّٰهُمَّ اِنِّىْ اَسْأَلُكَ اَنْ تَجْعَلَ لِيْ فِىْ هَذِهِ الْحَيٰٓةِ الْاٰخِرَةِ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا مِّنْ اَنْ يَّجْعَلَ لِيْ فِىْهَا مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ شَرًّا}$ "O Allah! Make not this life the greatest of our concerns nor the best knowledge that

we can attain .n* 11 Allah's statement, 4iSxl\ -L "Jd i. iVerily, your Lord is He, Who knows best him who goes astray from His path, and He knows best him who receives guidance.} meaning, He is the Creator of all creatures and He knows whatever benefits His servants. Allah is the One Who guides whom He wills and misguides whom He wills, and all of this indicates His power, knowledge and wisdom. Certainly, He is Just and never legislates or decrees unjustly. V—d Jlfj iAf- ujuifi j Cj j C Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :476

327Surah 53. An-Naim (31-32) (Part-27) iffip 431. And to Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with

what is best> 432. Those zoho avoid great sins and Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) except Al-Lamam - verily, your Lord is of vast forgiveness. He knoios you well when He created you from the earth (Adam), and when you were fetuses in your mothers' ivombs. So, ascribe not purity to yourselves. He knows best him who has Taqiva Allah knowsEvery Matter, whetherSmall or Big, andHe rewards Each according to His or Her Deeds Allah asserts that He is the King and Owner of the heavens and earth and that He is independent of the need for anyone. He is the authority over His creation and rules them with justice. He created the creation in truth, 4that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with what is best He recompenses each according to his or her deeds, good for good and evil for evil. Qualities of the Good-doers; Allah forgives the Small Faults Allah stated that the gooddoers are those who avoid major sins and immoral sins. They sometimes commit minor sins, but they will be forgiven these minor sins and covered from exposure, as Allah mentioned in another Ayah; 41fyou avoid the great sins which you are forbidden to do, VJe shall expiate from you your (small) sins, and admit you to a

Noble Entrance.^4:31) Allah said here, 4Those who avoid great sins and At-Fawahish (immoral sins) except Al-Lamam\$, Al-Lamam means, small faults and minor errors. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "I have not seen anything that resembles Al-Lamam better than the Hadith that Abu Hurayrah narrated from the Prophet \$5 , jliJl \Sji V klUi iijji 4 Ujji -ja da?- fii J>\ ii)l jj» ji vilJi J ' Oj'j dff£d\ "Verily, Allah the Exalted has decreed for the Son of Adam his share of Zina and he will certainly earn his share. The Zina of the eye is by looking, the Zina of the tongue is by talking and the heart wishes and lusts, but the sexual organ either substantiates all this or not.@"! This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs. [21 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said, "The eyes commit Zina by looking, the lips by kissing, the hands by transgressing, the feet by walking, and the sexual organ either materializes all of this or not. When one commits sexual intercourse, he will be someone who committed Zina. Otherwise, it is Al-Lamam."13 ' Masruq4 l and Ash-ShaTa also held the same view. 'Abdur- Rahman bin Nafi', who is also known as Ibn Lubabah At-Ta'ifi, said, "I asked Abu Hurayrah about Allah's statement, 4i3i' 4except the Lamam}, and he said, "It pertains to kissing, winking one's eye, looking and embracing. When the sexual organ meets the sexual organ in intercourse then Ghusl is obligatory, and that is Zina."15i Ahmad 2:276. Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :28 and Muslim 4 :2046. At-Tabari 22:537. At-Tabari 22:537. |s| At-Tabari 22:537.

329Surah 53. An-Najm (31-32) (Part-27) Encouraging Repentance and forbidding Claims of Purity for Oneself Allah's statement, y 2s U} iverily, your Lord is of vast forgiveness.} asserts that His Mercy

encompasses everything, and His forgiveness entails every type of sin, if one repents, U-Jr <_yUl' JCu u) Si ^--d fa faA itfa faA 4Say : "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy of Allah: verily, Allah forgives all sins. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} (39:53) Allah said, 4He knows you well when He created you from the earth,} Allah says, 'He was and still is the All-Knowing Whose knowledge encompasses your affairs, statements and all of the actions that will be committed by you, even when He created your father 'Adam from the earth and took his offspring from his loins, as small as ants. He then divided them into two groups, a group destined for Paradise and a group to Hellfire,' and when you were in your mothers' wombs. when He commanded the angel to record one's provisions, age, actions and if he would be among the miserable or the happy. Allah said, 4\$22 fa} 4So, ascribe not purity to yourselves.} forbidding one from ascribing purity and praising himself and thinking highly of his actions, fa} 4He knows best him who has Taqwa.} Allah said in another Ayah,

Vj •ilij & Jfj? «i' Jf (*r^^ o;j' jl j iHave you not seen those who claim sanctity for themselves. Nay, but Allah sanctifies whom He wills, and they will not be dealt with unjustly, even equal to the extent of a Fatty i] (4:49) In his Sahih, Muslim recorded that Muhammad bin 'Amr bin 'Ata said, "I called my daughter, Barrah (the pious one), and Zaynab bint Abu Salamah said to me, The Messenger of Allah M forbade using this name. I was originally called Barrah and he said, Jit JJU I ill jj jS'f V" "Do not ascribe purity to yourselves ; Allah knows best who the pious people among you are" They said, What should we call her?' He said, "Cf// her Zaynab Imam Ahmad recorded a Hadith from 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Bakrah, from his father who said, "A man praised another man before the Prophet The Messenger of Allah jjs said, i U-jU Jis lit - 131^ - jL-u jU diU j) Ltf w-l .fof ill JU Jjf ij fZ-J. '4>j Cyl jidi "ijui 'Jz o\S "Woe to you, you have cut off the neck of your friend! (He repeated this) If one of you must praise a friend of his, let him say, "I think that so-and-so is this and that; Allah knows best about him and I will never purify anyone before Allah," if he knows his friend to be as he is describing / iim.""*3' Al-Bukhari, Muslim, Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah collected this Hadith ^ The thread in the long slit of the date stone. Muslim 3:1687. Ahmad 5 :46 and 5 :41 Fath Al-B&r 5:324 and 10:491 and 567, Muslim 4:2296, Abu Dawud 5 : 154 and Ibn Majah 2 :1232

331 Surah 53. An-Naim (33-41) (Part-27) Imam Ahmad recorded that Hammam bin Al-Harith said, "A man came before 'Uthman bin 'Affan and praised him. Al- Miqdad bin Al-Aswad started throwing sand in the face of that man, saying, The Messenger of Allah sg ordered us to throw sand in their faces when we see those who praise.'" Muslim and Abu Dawud also collected this Hadith)2' ££ \$ jS in'3 si' 433. Did you observe him who turned away (from Islam).} 434. And gave a little, then stopped?} 435. Is with him the knowledge of the Unseen so that he sees?} 436. Or is he not informed with what is in the Suhuf of Musa,} 437. And of Ibrahim who fulfilled all that:} 438. That no burdened person (with sins) shall bear the burden (sins) of another.} 439 . And that man can have nothing but what he does.} 440. And that his deeds will be seen.} 441. Then he will be recompensed with a full and the best recompense.} Chastising Those Who disobey Allah and stop giving Charity Allah the Exalted chastises those who turn away from His obedience, 'J& Si i\$8fc% 31b 4So he (the disbeliever) neither believed nor prayed! But on the contrary, he belied and turned away!}(75:3\2>2), 4And gave a little, then stopped} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Gave a little, *** Ahmad 6 :5. * Muslim 4 :2297 and Abu Dawud 5 : 153

then stopped giving.” Similar was said by Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, Qatadah and several others.*21 ‘Ikrimah and Said said: “Like the case of a people who dig a well, during the course of which they find a rock preventing them from completing their work. So they say, “We are finished’ and they abandon the work.” Allah’s statement, 4Is with him the knowledge of the Unseen so that he sees? \$ means, does this person, who stopped giving for fear of poverty and ended his acts of charity have knowledge of the Unseen and thus knows that if he does not stop giving, his wealth will go away? No. Such a person has stopped giving in charity for righteous causes and did not keep relations with kith and kin because of his miserliness, being stingy and out of fear of poverty. The Prophet jg said in a Hadith, W-ttii ji j* jJ.J ‘jj jiiU “O Bilal, spend and fear not less provisions from the Owner of the 77ione.»*3 Allah the Exalted and Most honored said, iAnd whatsoever you spend of anything (in Allah’s cause), He will replace it. And He is the Best of providers.^ (34:39)

The Meaning of ‘fulfilled’

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5616–5627]

Allah the Exalted said, iOr is he not informed with what is in the Suhuf of Musa. And of Ibrahim who fulfilled K Said bin Jubayr and Ath-Thawri said it means: “Conveyed all that he was ordered to convey.”*4 Ibn ‘Abbas said about: ** At-Tabari 22:541. At-Tabari 22:542. At-Tabarani 10:191 At-Tabari 22:544.

333 Surah 53. An-Najm (33-41) (Part-27) ifulfilled £> “He delivered all that Allah ordered him to deliver.”111 Said bin Jubayr said about: ifulfilled “What he was ordered.” Qatadah said about: ifulfilled^, “He obeyed Allah and delivered His Message to His creatures.” This is the view preferred by Ibn Jarir because it includes the statement before it and supports it. Allah said, Jij jZAJtl iAtid (remember) when the Lord of Ibrahim tried him zoith (certain) commands, which he fulfilled. He said: “Verily, I am going to make you an Imam (a leader) for mankind.”^(2 :124) Therefore, Ibrahim fulfilled all the commands of his Lord, stayed away from all the prohibitions, and conveyed Allah’s Message in its entirety. Therefore, he is worthy of being made a leader for mankind in all of his affairs, statements and actions. Allah the Exalted said, i ‘j* Lj iJLi A e iThen, We have sent the revelation to you (saying) : “Follow the religion of Ibrahim, a Hanlf, and he zoas not of the idolators .”£>(16 :123) None shall carry the Burden of Any Other on the Day of Resurrection Allah the Exalted explained what He has revealed in the Scripture of Ibrahim and Musa, iThat no burdened person shall bear the burden of another. £> Meaning, every soul shall carry its own injustices, whether 111 At-Tabari 22 :543 121 At-Tabari 22:544.

disbelief or sin, and none else shall carry its burden of sin, as Allah states 6 of JsV iliS2 4And if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin.>(35:18) Allah said, 4And that man can have nothing but what he does.} So just as no soul shall carry the burden of any other, the soul shall only benefit from the good that one earns for himself. As for the Hadith recorded by Muslim in the Sahih, that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jgj said, Zsj-J) _ji td jf’Jj jjJ ja Sfl aJLIp jdail jLw^[l oli li]» j (oJUj ^y> “When a person dies, his deeds will cease except in three cases: from a righteous son who invokes Allah for him, or an ongoing charity after his death, or biowledge that people benefit from.d These three things are, in reality, a result of one’s own deeds, efforts and actions. For example, a Hadith states, J* aJlj jlj Cf! ^ jj « Verily, the best

type of provision that one consumes is from what he himself has earned, and one's offspring are among what he has earned.*121 The ongoing charity that one leaves behind, like an endowment, for example, are among the traces of his own actions and deeds. Allah the Exalted said. *lip''^ 4 Verily , We give life to the dead, and We record that which they send before (them) and their traces ,*}[36: 12) Muslim 3:1255. [a| An-Nasal 7:241.

335 Surah 53. Ati-Najm (42-55) (Part-27) The knowledge that one spreads among people which they are guided by is among his actions and deeds. A Hadith collected in the Sahih states, *Iri ^ ft Irf J* jyA ft; lyi ^ ft\ -f «Whoever invites to guidance, he will earn as much reward as those who follow him , without decreasing anything out of their own rewardsV* Allah said, 4And that his deeds will be seen . meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, gas ^ aup y&f 4And say: "Do deeds! Allah will see your deeds, and (so will) His Messenger and the believers . And you will be brought back to the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen. Then He will inform you of what you used to do.>(9:105), Then Allah will remind you of your actions and recompense you for them in the best manner, good for good and evil for evil. Allah's statement here, ip -ft iThen he will be recompensed with a full and the best recompense.> fr ft 1 { \$ J* ft ft i0&> 4 Jt Shi gv fijj li fcjft %pobVf U® a© "ft jjj j» ft SC\$ 5f C iptf 0^1 '£jP; psi \$ 3? ce 4 ^ iiyy 442. Ami f/iaf to your Lord is the End.} Muslim 4 :2060 "v*

443. And that it is He Who makes laugh, and makes weep 444. And that it is He Who causes death and gives life 445. And that He creates the pairs, male and female,} 446. From Nutfah when it is emitted.} 447 . And that upon Him is another bringing forth (Resurrection).} 448. And that it is He Who Aghna and Aqnd.} 449. And that He is the Lord of Ash-Shi'rd.} 450. And that it is He Who destroyed the former 'Ad,} 451 . And Thamiid. He spared none of them.} 452. And the people of Huh aforetime. Verily, they were more unjust and more rebellious and transgressing.} 453. And He destroyed the overthrown cities.} 454. So, there covered them that which did cover.} 455. Then which of the graces of your Lord will you doubt?} Some Attributes of the Lord, that He returns Man as He originated Him, and some of what He does with His Servants Allah the Exalted said, *d! dj} 4And that to your Lord is the End.} meaning, the return of everything on the Day of Resurrection. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Amr bin Maymun Al-Awdi said, "Once, Mu'adh bin Jabal stood up among us and said, 'O Children of Awd! I am the emissary of Allah's Messenger sg to you; know that the Return is to Allah, either to Paradise or the Fire.'"** 11 Allah's state- ment, *jim 4And that it is He Who makes you laugh, and makes you weep.} means that He created in His creatures the ability to laugh or m Al-Hakim 1 :83*

337 Surah 53. An-Najm (42-55) (Part-27) weep and the causes for each of these opposites, 4And that it is He Who causes death and gives life. In a similar statement, Allah said, *£P" 4Who has created death and life.\$(67:2) Allah said, 4 Oi jHi' yirxf P- 4And that He creates the pairs, male and female. From Nutfah when it is emitted. as He said: oi \$ is' 45? cJ 4Does man think that he will be left neglected? Was he not a Nutfah? Then he became an 'Alaqah (something that clings); then (Allah) shaped and fashioned (him) in due proportion. And made of him two sexes, male and female. Is not He (Allah) able to give life to the dead?\$(75:36-40) Allah the Exalted said, iSlf o'j4 4And that upon Him is another bringing forth.\$ meaning, just as He first originated creation, He is able to bring it back to life, resurrecting it for the Day of Judgement, 4And that it is He Who Aghnd (gives much) and Acpid (a little). It is Allah Who gives wealth to His servants and this wealth remains with them. This means they*

are able to use it to their benefit, is this out of the completeness of His favor. Most of the statements of the scholars of Tafsir revolve around this meaning, such as those from Abu Salih, Ibn Jarir and others.' Mujahid said that, m At-Tabari 22:548-549.

338 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAghria} meaning: He gives wealth. iAqnfy meaning: He gives servants. Similar was said by Qatadah. Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid said; iAghnfy means: He granted; while, iAqnd^ means: He gave contentment. ji /\$> iAnd that He is the Lord ofAsh-Shi'rd.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said about Ash- Shi'ra that it is the bright star, named Mirzam Al-Jawza (Sirius), which a group ofArabs used to worship.111 iAnd that it is He Who destroyed the former 'Adf the people of Hud. They are the descendants of 'Ad, son of Iram, son of Sam, son ofNuh. As Allah the Exalted said, iSaw you not how your Lord dealt with 'Ad. Of Iram, with the lofty pillars, the like of which were not created in the land?>(89:6-8) The people of 'Ad were among the strongest, fiercest people and the most rebellious against Allah the Exalted and His Messenger. Allah destroyed them, > Jld 1*3?* ew iBy a furious violent wind! Which Allah imposed in them for seven nights and eight days in succession .} {69:6-7) m At-Tabari 22 :551

339Surah 53. An-Najm (42-55) (Part-27) Allah's statement, iAnd Thamiid. He spared none}, declares that He destroyed them all and spared none of them, 433 oi }£¥ iAnd the people ofNuh aforetime .} before 'Ad and Thamud, A& '<& 4 iVerily, they were more unjust and more rebellious and transgressing .} more unjust in disobeying Allah them those who came after them, iAnd He destroyed the overthrown cities.} meaning, the cities (of Sodom and Gomorrah) to which Prophet Lut was sent. Allah turned their cities upside down over them and sent on them stones of Sijjil Allah's statement that whatever has covered it, has covered it, is like the case with the stones of Sijjil that He sent on them, if^\ : 'G ££\$> iAnd We rained on them a rain (of torment). And how evil was the rain of those who had been wamed!}(26:173) Allah said, Jcj S* \$4^ iThen which of the graces ofyour Lord will you doubt?} meaning, "which of Allah's favors for you, O man, do you doubt,' according to Qatadah. Ibn Jurayj said that the Ayah, Sc -Jo} iThen which of the graces ofyour Lord will you doubt?}, is directed towards the Prophet jg saying: "O Muhammad!" 111 At-Jabari 22:556. "s

340 Tafstr Ibt Kathlr ^ £3!rn ^However, the first ex planation is better, and it is the meaning that IbnJarirpreferred. lg?sL\$! ih j& iu* ot\$ 4\$ 4*jX\ IJCa jil % sjSvis; 4:?:ft!#t; i !45?s ^ [>VlililhdC ^i£LiLifjllj0JjVHjUuiil Tdj1j(t)i5^3 1^\$(ISjLi!(ily I * ^1*ul^iis{«}iSyil I {s^jiililjilu.jij jE >-**!}»' jAJj V." i' ,tjj-i*— ^jjj ,0jio 456. T/i/s is a wamer from the ivarners of old.} 457. The Azifah draws near.} i58. None besides Allah can avert it.} 459. Do you then wonder at this reci- tation?} 460. And you laugh at it and weep not,} 461. While you are Samidun.} 462. So fall you down in prostration to Allah and worship Him.} A Warning and Exhortation, the Order to prostrate and to be humble Allah said, 4°J &> 4This is a ivamer} in reference to Muhammad \$£,, UfT fh\& 4from the roomers ofold.} means, just like the warners of old, he was sent as a Messenger as they were sent as Messengers.

341Surah 53. An-Naint (56-62) (Part-27) Allah the Exalted said, 4Say: "1 aw not a new thing among the Messengers ."^>(46:9) Allah said; 4The Azifah draws near.} that which is near, the Day of Resurrection, has drawn nearer, 4 - s:' jll jjj l_f! iNone besides Allah can avert it.} no one besides Allah can prevent it from coming, nor does anyone know when it will come, except Him. The warner is eager to convey his knowledge of the imminence of a calamity, so that it does not befall those to whom he is a

warner. As He said; {He is only a warner to you in face of a severe torment.} (34:46) And in the Hadith: y.jl'i ut. «J am the naked warner, » meaning, 'I was in such a hurry to warn against the evil I saw coming, that I did not wear anything.' In this case, one rushes to warn his people in such haste that he will be naked. This meaning befits the meaning of the Ayah, 4:*;^ e-*}} {the Azifah draws near.}, in reference to the nearing Day of Resurrection. Allah said in the beginning of the Surah: 4*cljll' O/j'4 iThe Hour has drawn near.}(54:1) Imam Ahmad recorded that Sahl bin Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah^ said,

• j *' • + t > 'r , , > , jlu 1jJjj J115 oljA>xa o>lj£>%^j ^ * \$ %* * t ^ ^4 ^ ^ j j * 0 Oil^4>^* J^j l^>wiil O^nu ^ *L>-J £jj*j ^ 4 1^>-U^ Lfj JL>-^J tBeware of small sins! The example of the effect of small sin is that of people who settled near the bottom of a valley. One of them brought a piece of wood, and another brought another piece of wood, until they cooked their bread! Verily, small sins will destroy its companion, if one is held accountable for themj Allah the Exalted admonishes the idolaters because they hear the Qur'an, yet they turn away from it in heedless play, i wonder} doubting that it is true. iAnd you laugh in jest and mock at it, iand weep not,} just as those who believe in it weep. :k'1 >40;j Zljfe O&M iAnd they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their hutnility.>(17:109) Allah said; i: pd iWhile you are Samidun.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri reported that his father narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said about Samidun, "Singing; in Yemenite dialect 'Ismid for us' means 'Sing for us.'" 'Ikrimah said something similar.*21 In another narration from Ibn 'Abbas, he said that. 111 Ahmad 5:331. 121 At-Tabari 22:559.

343Surah 53. An-Najm (56-62) (Part-27) iSamidiin^ means, "Turning away."! ' Similar was reported from Mujahid and 'Ikrimah. Allah the Exalted ordered His servants to prostrate to Him, worship Him according to the way of His Messenger, and to fulfill the requirement of Tawhid and sincerity, 4So fall you down in prostration to Allah and worship Him.\$ meaning, with submission, sincerity, and Tawhid. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Ma'mar said that 'Abdul-Warith said that Ayyub said that Ikrimah said that, Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Prophet jg prostrated upon reciting An-Najm and the Muslims, idolaters, Jinns and mankind who were present prostrated along with him."*21 Only Muslim collected this Hadith. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Muttalib bin Abi Wada'ah said, "While in Makkah, the Messenger of Allah jg once recited Surat An- Najm, then prostrated along with all those who were with him at the time. I raised my head, however, and I refused to prostrate." Al-Muttalib had not embraced Islam yet, but ever since he became Muslim, he would never hear anyone recite this Surah until the end, without prostrating with whomever was prostrating after reciting it.131 An-Nasal also collected this Hadith in the Book of Al-Bukhari, excluding prayer in his SunanJ41

Surah 54: Al-Qamar

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5628–5658]

Opening 344 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir The Tafsīrof Surah Iqtarabat As-Sd'ahw (Chapter - 54) Which was revealed in Mafekah The Hadith of Abu Waqid preceded, in which it is mentioned that the Messenger of Allah jfc; would recite Surah Qaf (chapter 53) and Iqtarabat As-Sa'ah (Al-Qamar , chapter 54), during (the 'Id Prayers of) Al-Adha and Al-Fitr. The Prophet used to recite these two Surahs during major gatherings and occasions because they contain Allah's promises and warnings, and information about the origin of creation, Resurrection, Tawhid, the affirmation of prophethood, and so forth among the great objectives. 41 • The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft asunder.} 42. And if they see an Ayah, they turn away and say: "This is magic, Mustamir."} 43. They denied and followed their own lusts. And every matter will be settled.} 44. And indeed there has come to them news wherein there is Muzdajar.} 45. Perfect wisdom, but wamers benefit them not.} Also called Surat Al-Qamar.

The Hour draws near; the cleaving of the Moon Allah informs about the approach of the Last Hour and the imminent end and demise of the world, 'j3 4The Event ordained by Allah will come to pass, so seek not to hasten it. >(16:1), / > •> / •>* *» - ' \ iDraws near for mankind their reckoning, while they turn away in heedlessness >(21:1) Hadiths about the Last Hour There are several Hadiths with this meaning. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded that Anas said that one day, when the sun was about to set, the Messenger of Allah gave a speech to his Companions, saying, l-L» Ci!' j* U !;ju l_f~ / He in Whose Hand is my soul! Not much of this world is left compared to what has already passed of it, except as much as what is left in this day of yours compared to what has already passed of it. Anas said, "We could only see a small part of the setting sun at the time." Another Hadith that supports and explains the above Hadith is recorded by Imam Ahmad that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said, "We were sitting with the Prophet sg while the sun was rising above Qu'ayqa'an, 121 after 'Asr. He said, ^ J* JjL* 'J. jUi-i J> 'pSjUi- i U» !IWhat remains of your time, compared to what has passed, is as long as what remains of this day compared to what has passed o//f.»" 131 Majma'Az-Zawa'id 10:311. A hill in Makkah near the Hijr of the Ka'bah. Ahmad 2:115.

346 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Imam Ahmad recorded that Sahl bin Sa'd said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, • ipLUlj Ui «/ was sent like this with the Last Hour.® and he pointed with his middle and index finger. * The Two Sahih's also recorded this Hladffh.*2 Imam Ahmad recorded that Wahb As-Suwal said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, toj •j* a pLUlj Ui «i was sent just before the Last Hour, like the distance between this and this; the latter almost overtook the former .» Al-A'mash joined between his index and middle fingers while narrating this HadithP^ Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Awzal said that Ismail bin 'Ubaydullah said, "Anas bin Malik went to Al-Walid bin 'Abdul- Malik who

asked him about what he heard from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ about the Last Hour. Anas said, 'I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, *Ulillj j\$*» «You and the Last Hour are as close as these two (fingers)X” Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith.[^] There is proof to support these Hadiths in the Sahih listing, Al-Hashir (literally the Gatherer), among the names of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ; he is the first to be gathered, and all people will be gathered thereafter (for the Day of Judgement).^{*5} * Allah’s statement, *and the moon has been cleft asunder.*> It occurred during the time 111 Ahmad 5:338. * Fath Al-B&ri 1 :355 and Muslim 4 :2268 * Ahmad 4:309. ' Ahmad 3:223. ' Fath Al-Bdri 6:641.

347 Surah 54. Al-Oamar (1-5) (Part-27) of Allah’s Messenger ﷺ, according to the authentic Mutawatir Hadiths the scholars agree that the moon was cleft asunder during the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ, and it was among the clear miracles that Allah gave him. Hadiths mentioning that the Moon was split The Narration of Anas bin Malik Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “The people of Makkah asked the Prophet ﷺ for a miracle and the moon was split into two parts in Makkah. Allah said, *4The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft asunder* . Muslim also collected this Hadith^{f2^} Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas bin Malik said, “The people of Makkah asked the Messenger of Allah ﷺ to produce a miracle, and he showed them the splitting of the moon into two parts, until they saw (the mount of) yira’ between them.”¹³¹ This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahiths with various chains of narration. The Narration of Jubayr bin Mut'im Imam Ahmad recorded that Jubayr bin Mut'im said, “The moon was split into two pieces during the time of Allah’s Prophet ﷺ; a part of the moon was over one mountain and another part over another mountain. So they said, ‘Muhammad ﷺ has taken us by his magic.’ They then said, If he was able to take us by magic, he will not be able to do so with all people.”^{*41} Only Imam Ahmad recorded this Hadith with this chain of narration. Al-Bayhaqi used another chain of narration in a similar Hadith he collected in Ad-Dala’i⁰⁵] 111 Ahmad 3:165. Muslim 4:2159. ^{*31} Fath Al-Bari 7 :221 and 8 :484 and Muslim 4 :2159. Ahmad 4 :81 * Dala’ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :268

The Narration of 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, “The moon was split during the time of the Prophet ﷺ.” * Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this Hadith.^{*2} * Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn 'Abbas commented on Allah’s saying: “ *liri) icd!*” \$The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft asunder. And if they see a sign, they turn away and say: “This is magic, Mustamir.”} “This occurred before the Hijrah; the moon was split and they saw it in two parts.”^{*3} The Narration of 'Abdullah bin 'Umar Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar commented on Allah’s statement: *las iThe Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft asunder.*} “This occurred during the time of Allah’s Messenger ﷺ; the moon was split in two parts. A part of it was before the mount and a part on the other side. The Prophet ﷺ said, “O Allah! Be witnessJ’ ”^{*4} This is the narration that Muslim and At-Tirmidhi collected.^{*5} At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih.” The Narration of 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said, “The moon was split in two parts during the time of Allah’s Messenger, and they saw its two parts. Allah’s Messenger ﷺ said, Fath Al-Bari 8 :484 ^{*2}] Fath Al-Bari 7 :22 1 and Muslim 4 :2 159 . * At-Tabari 22:569. * Dala’ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :267 Muslim 4 :2 158-2159 and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 : 175

«Be witnesses.*” Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this HadithP Ibn Jarii recorded that 'Abdullah (Ibn Mas'ud) said, “I saw the mountain between the two parts of the moon when it was split.”¹³ ' Imam

Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah said, “The moon was split during the time of Allah’s Messenger and I saw the mount between its two parts.”*4 ‘ The Stubbornness of the idolators Allah said, & 1£ iAnd if the)/ see an Ayah}, if they see proof, evidence and a sign, it they turn away}, they do not believe in it. Rather, they turn away from it, abandoning it behind their backs, iand say: "This is magic, Mustamir."} They say, the sign that we saw was magic, which was cast on us.’ Mustamir, means, will soon go away’, according to Mujahid, Qatadah¹⁵¹ and several others. The Quraysh said that the cleaving of the moon was false and will soon diminish and fade away, ⁴They denied and followed their own lusts.}, they rejected the truth when it came to them, following the ignorance and foolishness that their lusts and desires called them to. Allah’s statement, Ahmad 1 :377. Fath Al-Bari 8 :483 and Muslim 4:2158. At-Tabari 22 :567 ‘ Ahmad 1 :413 |S| At-Jabari 22:570.

iAnd every matter iwill be settled.} means, the good deeds will take their doers to all that is good and righteous, and similarly evil deeds will take their doers to all that is evil, according to Qatadah,’ while Ibn Jurayj said, “will settle according to its people.”²¹ Mujahid commented on the meaning of, iAnd every matter will be settled.} by saying, “On the Day of Resurrection.” Allah’s statement. iAtid indeed there has come to them news}-, in this Qur’an, there has come to them the news of the earlier nations that disbelieved in their Messengers and the torment, punishment and affliction that befell them, JL f s * •A iwherein there is Muzdajjar}, wherein there are warnings and lessons to stop them from idolatry and persisting in denial, iPerfect wisdom,} in that Allah guides whomever He wills and misguides whomever He wills, ibut warners benefit them not.} but the preaching of warnings does not benefit those upon whom Allah has written misery and sealed their hearts. Who can guide such people after Allah? This Ayah is similar to Allah’s statements, ;tS> i&S& iSay : “With Allah is the perfect proof and argument; had He so willed, He would indeed have guided you all.”^(6:149) and, iBut neither Aydt nor warners benefit those who believe not.}{10.01) At-Tabari 22:572. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :673

A CiL p; Jyb 3[V .v >jriJLi 46. So withdraw from them. The Day that the caller will call (them) to a terrible thing.} 47. They will come forth, with humbled eyes from (their) graves as if they were locusts spread abroad,} i8. Hastening towards the caller. Tlte disbelievers xvill say: "This is a hard Day."} The terribleEnd the Disbelievers willmeet on the Day of Resurrection Allah the Exalted says, ‘O Muhammad, turn away from these people who, when they witness a miracle, they deny it and say that this is continuous magic.’ Turn away from them and wait until, ⁴>^ }Cr-4 £\$> £*4 {J>} iThe Day that the caller will call (them) to a terrible thing.} to the Recompense and the afflictions, horrors and tremendous hardships that it brings forth, i% c4 £&¥ iwith humbled eyes}, their eyes will be covered with disgrace, it they will come forth from (their) graves as if they were locusts spread abroad.} They will gather towards the area of Reckoning in such haste and crowds, in response to the caller, as if they were crowds of locusts spreading all about. Allah said, ⁴Hastening^ meaning hurriedly, ⁴g< 3i> Howards the caller.} without being able to hesitate or slow down, ⁴_/4 fj>

rejected!} 415. And indeed. We have left this as a sign. Then is there any that will remember 416. Then how (terrible) was My torment and My warnings?} 417. And We have indeed made the Qur’an easy to understand and remember; then is there anyone who will remember?} The Story of the People of Nuh and the Lesson from it Allah the Exalted said, ⁴£} 4denied} “before your people, O Muhammad,’ ⁴^ ! *& 4the people of Niih. They rejected Our servant} means, they denied him categorically and accused

him of madness, and said: "A madman!" Wazdujir.} Mujahid said about Wazdujir. "He was driven out accused on account of madness." 11 It was also said that Wazdujir means, he was rebuked, deterred, threatened and warned by his people saying: 4 "If you do not stop O Nuh, you will be among those who will be stoned." [26: 1 16] This was said by Ibn Zayd, 12 and it is sound. 4 Then he invoked his Lord (saying): "I have been overcome, so help (me)!" meaning, 'I am weak and cannot overcome or resist my people, so help Your religion!' Allah the Exalted said, jlc < l, ; Ji . 4 So, We opened the gates of the heaven with water 11 At-Jabari 22:576. At-Jabari 22:577.

Munhamir.} As-Suddi said about Munhamir, "It means abundant." 11 ' 4 '***®' ijr*j} 4 And We caused springs to gush forth from the earth.} means, from every part of the earth, and even ovens in which fire was burning - water and springs gushed forth, Ja%} 4 So, the waters met}, means, of the heaven and the earth, fS -&} ifor a matter predestined.} Ibn Jurayj reported from Ibn 'Abbas: ^r* .Ot } So, We opened the gates of the heaven with water Munhamir}, Torrential rain, the only water that fell from the sky before that day and ever since was from clouds. But the sky's gates were opened on them that day, and therefore, the water that came down was not from clouds. So both the waters (of the earth and the heaven) met according to a matter ordained." 21 Allah said, } And We carried him on a (ship) made of planks and nails (Dusur)}, Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Qurazi, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said that Dusur means nails.' 3 * Ibn Jarir preferred this view.' 4 Allah's statement, 4 Floating under Our Eyes}, means, "by Our command and under m Al-Qurtubi 17:131. Ad-Durr Al-ManthUr 7 :675 At-Tabari 22 : 580 and Al-Qurtubi 17 :132. At-Tabari 22:578.

355 Surah 54. Al-Oamar (9-17) (Part-27 Our protection and observation,' 4 ft ftA •&¥ ia reward for him who had been rejected!} meaning, as recompense for them because of their disbelief in Allah and as reward for Nuh, peace be upon him. Allah the Exalted said, 4 ft Af} i And indeed, We have left this as a sign.} Qatadah said, "Allah left the ship of Nuh intact until the first generation of this Ummah were able to see it." However, it appears that the meaning here is that Allah kept ships as a sign. For instance, Allah the Exalted said, 4 Aft J~&. £ .ft* cAA J' 4 LU- lil (• i And a sign for them is that We bore their offspring in the laden ship. And We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride>(36:41-42), S* ~Qj P« 4 P& £\$&6 i Verily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the boat. That We might make it an admonition for you and that it might be retained by the retaining ears.}{69:1 1-12) Allah's statement here, i Then is there any that will remember?} means, 'is there any that will receive admonition and reminder. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mastid said, "The Prophet jg recited to me, 4 ft oi i Then is there any that will remember?}" 121 Al-Bukhari collected a similar Hadith from 'Abdullah that he said, "I recited to the Prophet jg [M At-Jabari 22:582. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :485

(then is there any that will remember) and the Prophet sg said,' 4 Then is there any that will remember?}" Allah's statement, 4 Then hoiv (terrible) was My torment and My warnings?} means, 'how terrible was My torment that I inflicted on those who disbelieved in Me and denied My Messengers, who did not heed to My warnings? How was My help that I extended to My Messengers and the revenge exerted on their behalf,' 4 J)& j:\ \$ ^} i Atid We have indeed made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember}; meaning, We have made the Qur'an easy to recite and comprehend for those who seek these traits, to remind mankind,' as Allah said. Vi 4 (This is) a Book which We have sent down to you,

full of blessings, that they may ponder over its ayat, and that men of understanding may remember.} (38:29), 4So We have made this (the Qur'an) easy in your own tongue, only that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwa and warn with it the most quarrelsome people.} (19:97) Allah said, 4then is there any that will remember}, meaning, Is there anyone who will remember through this Qur'an, which We made easy [i] Path Al-Bari 8 :484

357Surah 54. Al-Oamar (18-22) (Part-27) to memorize and easy to understand?' Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi commented on this Ayah, "Is there anyone who will avoid evil?" 111 jW* J - * ' 1 £/ 418. "Ad denied; then how was My torment and My warnings?" 119. Verily, We sent against them a violently cold (Sarsar) wind on a day of calamity, continuous.} 420. Plucking out men as if they were uprooted stems of date palms.} 421. Then, how was My torment and My warnings?" 422. And We have indeed made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any that will remember?"

The Story of 'Ad Allah states that 'Ad, the People of Hud, denied their Messenger, just as the people of Nuh did. So, Allah sent on them, against them a violently cold (Sarsar) wind}, means, a bitterly cold and furious wind, £& 4om a day of calamity}, against them, according to Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and As-Suddi, (2 continuous} , upon them because the calamity, torment and destruction that they suffered in this life on that day continued with that of the Hereafter, ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :676 121 At-Tabari 22 : 587

ii j2 fie iPlucking out men as if they were uprooted stems of date palms.} The wind would pluck one of them and raise him high, until he could no longer be seen, and then violently send him down on his head to the ground. His head would be smashed and only his body would be left, headless, * Jk scjk S3% && ; t ; j2 &i1 fie ias if they were uprooted stems of date palms. Then, how was My torment and My warnings? And We Iwve indeed made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any that will remember?" i\ j? ^& ^ '\$rt¥ (*rii 331 J irftjLJj fiufc fi ip lilji Cj ' jjij c^Ijc *# Jail SCj3t £3 32;^£3 423. Thamiid denied the warnings.} 424. And they said: "A man, alone among us - shall we follow him? Truly, then we should be in error and distress!"} 425. "Is it that the Reminder is sent to him alone from among us? Nay, he is an insolent liar!"} 426. Tomorrow they will come to know who is the liar, the insolent one!} 427. Verily, We are sending the she-camel as a test for them. So watch them, and be patient!} 428. And inform them that the water is to be shared between (her and) them, each one's right to drink being established (by turns).} 429. But they called their comrade and he took (a sword) and killed (her).}

430. Then, how was My torment and My warnings?" 431. Verily, We sent against them a single Sayhah, and they became like straw Al-Muhtazir.} 432. And indeed, We have made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any that will remember?" The Story of Thamud Allah states here that the people of Thamud denied their Messenger Salih, 4And they said: "A man, alone among us - shall we follow him? Truly, then we should be in error and distress!"} They said, We would have earned failure and loss if we all submitted to a man from among us.' They were amazed that the Reminder was sent to him alone among them, and therefore, accused him of being a liar, 4^y 4Nay, he is an insolent liar!}, means, he has trespassed the limits in his lies. Allah the Exalted responded, j* >Je o 4Tomorrow they will come to know who is the liar, the insolent one!}, thus warning and threatening them and delivering a sure promise to them, 4\$ *4 4Verily, We are sending the she-camel as a test for

them.} To test and try the people of ThamUd, Allah sent to them a superb, pregnant female camel that emerged from solid rock, according to their request, so that it would become a proof against them from Allah, the Exalted. Thereafter, they were supposed to believe in what was brought to them by Salih, peace be upon him. Allah ordered His servant and Messenger Salih, 4'j£& -f&%}

iSo watch than, and be patient!} Allah commanded, 'await, O Salih, and see what will become of them and be patient; verily the better end will be yours and you will have success in this life and the Hereafter,' iUl o'K,—i- aji j' j»t <And inform them that the water is to be shared between them} one day for her to drink and one day for them to drink, 4 /Ji 4/r Ziji. Cl iii 4He said: "Here is a she-camel: it has a right to drink, and you have a right to drink (water) on a day, known."} (26:155) Allah's statement, ieach one's right to drink being established.} Mujahid said, "When she did not drink, they would drink the water, and when she drank, they would drink her milk." Allah the Exalted said; J'Wi in 4But they called their comrade and he took and killed.} According to the Scholars of Tafsir, his name was Qudar bin Salif; he was the evilest among them, 4When the most wicked man among them went forth (to kill the she-camel).}(91:12) Allah said here, iand he took} meaning to harm, 4*& 4S iand killed Oxer). Then, how was My torment and My warnings?}, 1 tormented them, so how was the torment I sent on them At-Tabari 22 :592

because of their disbe- lief in Me and denying My Messenger?' *.w> pfy CLj' i:«: ^ ga 4 Verily, We sent against them a single Saylrnh, and they became like straw Al- Muhtazir. They all perished and none of them remained. They were no more, they died out, just as plants and grass dry and die out. As-Suddi said that they became like the diy grass in the desert when it becomes burned and the wind scatters it all about. Ibn Zayd said, "The Arabs used to erect fences (Hizar, from which the word, Al-Muhtazir, is derived) made of dried bushes, around their camels and cattle, so Allah said, 4j£Z mm .<J»j!JUV ^J jjJj^jjllL Qp j ~j —* Julj y »// Vj ,#*///, Z" *<i A o' ^ -Xi3j { *3j-bjvj^~^ Z-' v x v ii/ j»> blblL^jS ^ ZZ ^/fZz -j^r <Z > , > > 4/ite straw Al-Muhtazir ui ^ y~—> pV' Jyl J'» ^ C-e^- pt^ SJ % jly) pj» ^ tZ Jjij . jXJ*j IzjtJA pjb;jj^ Jjij T3 ., ij* dC/r » * * > * < » * * /" ^>1 / •'<' «.'% J - •?< r/ •*|T ,»-' »4»*?»* -*iy ! Am>* ** *. 1- -[J&* 0; J^Sl o'v«j' 6/J jiJj -'7*jjy 433 . T/ie people of Lilt denied the warnings. 434. Verily, We salt against them Hdsib (a violent storm of

362 Tafstr Ibn Kathir stones), except the family of Lut, them We saved in the last hour of the night,} 435. As a favor from Us. Thus do We reward him who gives thanks 436. And he indeed had warned them of Our punishment, hut they doubted the warnings!} 437. And they indeed sought to shame his guests. So, We blinded their eyes (saying), "Then taste you My torment and My warnings."} 438. And verily, an abiding torment seized them early in the tnoming.} 439. Then taste you My torment and My warnings.} 440. And indeed, We have made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any that will remember?} The Stoty of the People of the Prophet Lut Allah the Exalted states that the people of Ltt{: defied and denied their Messenger and committed sodomy, the awful immoral sin that no people in the history of mankind had committed before. This is why Allah destroyed them with a type of torment that He never inflicted upon any nation before them. Allah the Exalted commanded Jibril, peace be upon him, to raise their cities to the sky and then turn them upside down over them, followed by stones made of marked Sy/fl.111 So He said here: 4/-J LjC t&y E^ 4Verily, We sent against them Hasib (a violent storm of stones) except the family of Lut, them We saved in the last hour

of the night.} They left the city in the last part of the night and were saved from the torment that struck their people, none of whom believed in Lot. And even Lot's wife suffered the same end as her people. Allah's Prophet Lut left Sodom with his daughters in safety, unharmed. Allah said, Ii] See the Tafstrof SurahHud

xjfjjfd. ,>• <sy*- iThus do V\Ie reward him who gives thanks. And fie indeed had warned them ofOur punishment,) meaning, before the torment struck his people, he warned them of Allah's torment and punishment. They did not heed the warning, nor listen to Lut, but instead doubted and disputed the warning. iAnd they indeed sought to shame his guests) that is the night the angels Jibril, Mika'il and Israfil came to him in the shape of handsome young men, as a test from Allah for Lut's people. Lut hosted his guests, while his wife, the evil old one, sent a message to her people informing them of Lut's guests. They came to him in haste from every direction, and Lut had to close the door in their faces. They came during the night and tried to break the door; Lut tried to fend them off, while shielding his guests from them, saying, 0 ji ti>' iThese are my daughters, if you must act (so).)' (15:71), in reference to their women, iThey said: "Surely, you know that we have neither any desire nor need ofyour daughters!"(l:79), meaning, "we do not have any desire for women,' iand indeed you know well what we want!}(1 1:79) When the situation became serious and they insisted on coming in, Jibril went out to them and struck their eyes with the tip of his wing, causing them to lose their sight. They went back feeling for the walls to guide them, threatening Lot with what would befall him in the morning. Allah the Exalted said, /JTL# ' m> a" »//<> \ 4 yi—* vL* Jibr 4And verily, an abiding torment seized them early in the morning.)

meaning, a torment that they had no way of escaping or avoiding, .\$.)) >' >1 jJy i^Ue. lyjjif AThen taste you My torment and My warnings. And indeed, We have made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any that will remember?} *te& (SZ &&& * 4 \$ jf ^Jji \$ JeLdlj jUugj* iAiS' J? <(42. And indeed, learnings came to the people of Fir aivn.} A42. (They) denied all Our signs, so We seized them with a punishment of the Almighty, All-Capable. 443. Are your disbelievers better than these? Or have you immunity in the Divine Scriptures?} 444. Or say they : "We are a great multitude, victorious?"} 445. Their multitude will be put to flight, and they will show their backs.} Nay, but the Hour is their appointed time, and the Hour will be more grievous and more bitter.} The Story ofFir'awn and His People Allah the Exalted narrates to us the story of Fir'awn and his people. A Messenger came to them from Allah, Musa supported by his brother Harun. Their Messengers delivered good news if they believe, and a warning if they rejected the Message. Allah supported Musa and Harun with tremendous miracles and great signs, but Fir'awn and his people rejected all of them. Allah took them the way the All-Mighty, the All- Capable would; He destroyed them all leaving none surviving to tell the story of what happened to them. Advising and Threatening the Quraysh Allah said,

4Are your disbelievers> meaning, 'O idolaters of the Quraysh,' <£& % ibetter than these?} meaning better than the nations that were mentioned here, who were destroyed on account of their disbelief in the Messengers and rejecting the Scriptures. 'Are you better than these?' 4p 4 £ f} iOr have you immunity in the Divine Scriptures?}, 'do you have immunity from Allah that the torment and punishment will not touch you?' Allah said about the Quraysh, 40r say they : "We are a great multihide, victorious?"} stating that they believed they will support each other and their great gathering will avail

them against those who intend to harm them. Allah the Exalted responded, 4Their multihide will be put to flight, and they will shoio their backs.} affirming that their gathering shall scatter, and they shall be defeated. Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Prophet jg, while in a dome-shaped tent on the day of the battle of Badr, said, «0 Allah! I ask you for the fulfillment of Your covenant and promise. O Allah! If You zvis (to destroy the believers), You will never be worshipped on the earth after todayj Abu Bakr caught him by the hand and said, This is sufficient, O Allah’s Messenger! You have sufficiently asked and petitioned Allah.’ The Prophet sg was clad in his armor at that time and went out, saying, S. . Sfyj iljLl

J nmm #r ' mmmx jjJj > \ ". . -i 0 0&\$\ o\1Z^^j^JL11\0oCJIUlt g)jy3J}\jalu'£\ iVieir multitude will be put to flight and they will show their backs. Nay, but the Hour is their appointed time and that Hour will be more grievous and more bitter.y*1] Al-Bukhari also recorded that Yusuf bin Mahak said, “I was with the Mother of the faithful, ‘A’ishah, when she said, “When I was still a young playful girl in Makkah, this Ayah was revealed to Muhammad jg, tfSS to& S¥ 43t.!& iNay, but the Hour is their appointed time and that Hour will be more grievous and more bitter . >” This is the abridged narration that Al-Bukhari collected, but he also collected a longer narration of it in the Book of the Virtues of the Qur’an.12 * Muslim did not collect this Hadith. ^2- o-* !a>> rftw& <4 (j ^!cC2i u£i»1 jciij igijZit iij jT 4 jd 4 jcr Jd ^£=>ju o» J+i ^MPi 5** 4-V 4 \$*yrJ y£“- 4 Os¥l{ 447. Verily, the criminals are in error and will bum> 1 1] Fath Al-Bari 8 :485-486 Fath Al-Bari 8 :486 and 8 :655

367Surah 54. Al-Oamar (47-55) (Part-27) 448. The Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire (it will be said to them): "Taste you the touch ofHell!"} 449. Verily, We have created all things with Qadar.} 450. And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling ofan eye.} 451. And indeed. We have destroyed your likes; then is there any that will remember?} 452. And everything they have done is noted in Az-Zubur.} 453. And everything, small and large, is written down.} 454. Verily, those who have Taqwa, will be in the midst of Gardens and Rivers.} 455. In a seat of truth, near the Muqtadir King.} The Destination ofthe Criminals Allah the Exalted states that the criminals are misguided away from the truth and engulfed in confusion, because of the doubts and uncertainty they are in. This description befits every disbeliever and innovator of all types and forms of sects. Allah the Exalted said, I. *> V A ‘t*--4 . (s.r 4The Day they will be dragged on theirfaces into the Fire}, meaning, just as they were consumed in doubt, suspicion and hesitation, they ended up in the Fire. And just as they were misguided, they will end up being dragged on their faces, unaware of where they will be taken. They will be admonished and criticized, 4“Taste you the touch ofHell!”} Everythingwas created with Qadar Allah’s statement, 4Verily, We have created all things with Qadar.} is similar to several other Aydt,

<He has created everything, and has measured it exactly according to its due measurements (Faqaddarahu Taqdir).\$> (25:2) and, Ji Jfc «£»• Cjjjft i£J ill iGlorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High. Who has created (everything), and then proportioned it. And Who has measured (Qaddara) and then guided.\$(87:1-3), i.e., He measured out the total sum (Qadai) of everything and then guided the creation to it. The Imams of the Sunnah relied on this honorable Ayah as evidence that Allah created the creation with destined limits before they were created. He knew everything that will occur before it occurred and recorded everything that will occur, before they occurred. They used this Ayah and similar Ayat and Hadxths to refute the Qadariyyah sect, who started their sect during the latter time of the

Companions. I mentioned this subject in detail in my explanation on the chapter on faith of Sahih Al-Bukhari. I will mention here some Hadiths pertaining to this honorable Ayah. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The idolators of the Quraysh came to the Messenger of Allah arguing with him and discounting the Qadar. This Ayah was revealed, 4 (s.r iThe Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire: "Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with Qadar.yW Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah collected this Harlfth 121 Al-Bazzar recorded that 'Amr bin Shu'ayb said that his father narrated that his grandfather said, "These Ayat were revealed about those who deny Al-Qadar, -V- < f - > «. > > H o-* !>*> r*?SrJ Ahmad 1 :444. Muslim 4 :2046 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 : 176 and Ibn Majah 1 :32

4Verily , the criminals are in error and will bum. The Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire: "Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with Qadar.y Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded that Zurarah said that his father said that the Prophet jg recited this Ayah, i"Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with Qadar.} and then said, ' ' ' * " * " «These Ayat were revealed about some members ofmy Ummah. They will come before the end of time and deny Al-Qadar .»121 Ata' bin Abi Rabah said, "I went to Ibn 'Abbas and found him drawing water from the well of Zamzam. The bottom of his clothes were wet with the water ofZamzam and I said to him, They talked about Al-Qadar (some denied it).' He asked, "Have they done this?" I said, 'Yes.' He said, 'By Allah! This Ayah was revealed only about them. i"Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with Qadar .\$. They are the worst members of this Ummah. Do not visit those who fall ill among them or pray the Funeral prayer for those among them who die. If I saw one of them, I would pluck out his eyes with these two fingers of mine.'"131 Imam Ahmad recorded that Nafi' said, " 'Abdullah bin 'Umar had a friend in the area of Ash-Sham who used to write to him. 'Abdullah bin 'Umar wrote to him, 1 was told that you Kashf Al-Astar 3:72, there is a slight deficiency in its chain of narration (21 At-Tabarani 5:276. Ibn Abi Hatim no. 18715, Juz'Al-Hasan bin 'Arafah 46.

372Surah 54. Al-Oamar (47-55) (Part-27 cause you some benefit that Allah has not decreed for you, they will never be able to bring you that benefit. And if they gather their strength to bring a harm to you that Allah has not written on you, they will never be able to harm you. The pens have gone dry and the Books ofRecord have been closed .»,1] Imam Ahmad recorded that Ubadah bin Al-Walld bin Ubadah said that his father said to him, "I went to 'Ubadah when he was ill, and I thought that he was going to die. So 1 said, 'O my father, advise us and make the best effort in this regard.' He said, 'Help me sit up,' and when he was helped up, he said, 'O my son! Know that you will not taste the delight of Faith or earn true knowledge in Allah until you believe in Al- Qadar, the good and the not so good parts of it.' I asked, 'O my father! How can I know (or believe in) Al-Qadar, the good and the not so good parts of it?' He said, When you know that what has missed you, would never have come to you and what has befallen you would never have missed you. O my son! I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, > U, UIUI ill: J .4^1 :«J J]» jli ^1 liil Jjj. U Jjl !)U «The first thing Allah created zuas the Pen, right after that commanded it, 'Record!' and the Pen recorded everything that will occur until the Day ofResurrection .» O my son! If you die not having this belief, you will enter the Hellfire.'"121 At-Tirmidhi also recorded it and said: "Hasan Sahih Gharib .»]3 ' It is confirmed in Sahih Muslim from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr that the Messenger of Allah jg said, JTT t Verily, Allah recorded the measurements for the creahtres fifty

thousand years before He created the heavens and earth.* Ibn Wahb added, 111 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:219. ,2) Ahmad 5:317. I3 * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :368

j* A-ijft ^And His Throne was over the water.)(1 1:7) At-Tirmidhi also recorded it, and he said: “Hasan, Sahih Gharfb.’W A Warning to beware ofAllah’s Threats Allah said, iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.) This is information about the execution of His will in His creation, just as He informed us the execution of His decree in them, Vi VJ\ iAnd Our commandment is but one> meaning, We only command a thing once, without needing to repeat the command; and whatever We command comes to existence faster than the blinking of an eye without any delay, not even for an instant.’ Allah said, iAnd indeed, We have destroyed your likes), i.e. the earlier nations who denied their Messengers, itthen is there any that will remember?) meaning, is there any that will receive admonition by remembering the humiliation and torment that Allah decreed for them? iAnd a barrier will be set betioeen them and that which they desire, as was done in the past ivith the people of their kind.M34:54) Allah’s statement, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :370 .

4 4 •jL-Zl’ }CA j 4Arid everything they have done is noted in Az-Zubur.> meaning, everything they did is recorded in the Books of Record entrusted to the angels, peace be upon them, 4And everything, small and large,> meaning, of their actions, 4^» 4is written down .\$.> everything that they do is recorded and written in their Record of deeds, which leave nothing, whether large or small, but it is recorded and counted. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, 0 CJIL 4il ‘jA 14J jli “O ‘A’ishah! Beiuare of small sins, because there is someone assigned by Allah who records them .*111 An-Nasal and Ibn Majah also collected this HadithJ21 The Good End for Those with Taqwa Allah said, 4 Verily, those who have Taqiuua, will be in the midst ofCardens and Rivers . >, unlike the end that the miserable are facing, loss, confusion and being dragged in the Fire on their faces, as well as being disgraced, punished and threatened. Allah said, 41)’ a seat of truth , in the Dwelling of Allah’s honor, encompassed by His pleasure, favors, bounties, generosity and compassion. Ahmad 6:151. Tuhfat Al-Ashraf 12 :250 and Ibn Majah 2 : 14 17.

itiear the Muqtadir King.) meaning with the Magnificent King Who created everything and measured its destiny; He is able to grant them whatever they wish and ask for. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr said that the Prophet jg said, i&x If jy If sf* J jj’v-iJl° 1’^3 ^3 ^-fc^3 p- cj? « Verily , the just will be with Allah on podiums of light, to the right ofAr-Ralxman, and both ofHis Hands are right. They are those ivho are just and fair in their judgement and with their families and those whom they are responsible for.’i’11 Muslim and An-Nasal also recorded this HadithJ2

Surah 55: Ar-Rahman

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The Tafsirof SuratAr-Rahman

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5659–5692]

(Chapter - 55) Which was revealed in Makkah The Introduction to SuratAr-Rahman Imam Ahmad recorded that Zirr said that a man said [to Ibn Mas'ud]: '1 ' "How is this recited?"21 "Ma'in Ghayri Yasin or Asm?" He asked him, "Are you that proficient in reciting the whole Qur'an?" He replied, "I recite the Mufasssal section in one Rak'ah." So he said, "Woe to you! Do you recite the Qur'an in haste, as if it is poetry? I know that the Prophet sg used to recite two Surahs from the beginning of the Mufasssal section (in one Rak'ah)." And Ibn Mas'ud considered Surat Ar- Rahman to be the beginning of the Mufasssal section.13' Abu 'Isa At-Tirmidhi recorded that Jabir said, "The Messenger of Allah jg went to his Companions and recited Surat Ar-Rahman from beginning to end for them, but they did not say anything. The Prophet jg said, UK cK \jjLSsi -til' illi </ recited it to the Jinns, on the night of the Jinns and their response was better than yours! Whenever I recited Allah's statement: iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} They said, "None of Your favors do we deny, our Lord! All praise is due to you."> At-Tirmidhi recorded it and he said, "This Hadith is l 1 As appears in the narration with Ahmad. Similar is recorded from Ibn Mas'Qd by Muslim, no. 822. '2 ' This is Surah Muhammad 47 :15 131 Ahmad 1 :4 12

376 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Gharib,"*1 ' Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar also collected this Hadith.W Abu Jafar Ibn Jarir recorded that 'Abdullah bin Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg recited Surat Ar-Rahman, or it was recited before him, and he said, "Why do I hear the Jinn giving a better response to their Lord than you? They said, "Why is that, O Allah's Messenger?" He said, i : oJij NI (&> 3» &f} : 41 6'y 'Ji 1S\ l> > .'*** * , • ; U»J {jA 'Whenever I recited the statement of Allah the Exalted, iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} The Jinn responded by saying, "None of the favors of our Lord do we deny Al-Hafiz Al-Bazzar also collected this Hadith. In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 4 &*it; ^-itjps Lg^sSft Vj .kljll ^iyj' c2f 3: «& ^ iu j&t; tgs Ar-Rahman!} 42. He has taught the Qur'an.} 43. He created man.} 44. He taught him Al-Bayan.} 45. The sun and the moon (run) on fixed courses.} 111 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :177. 121 Al-Hakim, 2:473. 131 At-Tabari 23:23. KashfAl-Astar 3 :74

377Surah 55. Ar-Rahman (1-13) (Part-27) i6. And the Najm and the trees prostrating.} 4?. And the heaveti He has raised high, and He has set up the balance.} }8. In order that you may not transgress the balance.} 49. And observe the weight with equity and do not make the balance deficient.} 410. And the earth He has put down (laid)for At-An'am.} 411 Therein are fruits, date palms producing Akmam.} 412. And also com, with (its) 'Asf, and Rayhan.} 413. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Ar-Rahman revealed and taught the Qur'an Allah informs of His favors and His mercy for

His creatures, for He revealed the Qur'an to His servants, He made memorizing and understanding of it easy for those on whom He has bestowed His mercy, 4Ar-Rahman! He has taught the Qur'an. He created man. He taught him Al-Bayan.} Al-Hasan said: "Eloquent speech." This refers to Allah teaching the Qur'an, that is, teaching the servants how to recite it by making it easy for them to speak and pronounce letters with the various parts of the mouth, such as the alveolar bridge, the tongue and the lips. Among Allah's Signs: the Sun, the Moon, the Sky and the Earth Allah said, 2% "h\} 4The sun and the moon (run) on fixed courses.} They move in their orbit in perfect succession, according to precise calculation that is never delayed nor disturbed, 4 jy 'ij JH! Li ") } 4It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night

outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.}[36:40), jJA*. 4(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for calculating. Such is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing.} (6:96), Allah said, 4And the Najm and the trees prostrating .} Ibn Jarir commented, "Scholars of Tafsir disagreed over the meaning of Allah's statement, 'And the Najm.' They agreed, however, that the trees mentioned here are those that stand on trunks."* 11 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "An-Najm refers to the plants that lay on the ground."*2 Similar was said by Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi and Sufyan Ath-Thawri.*3 * This is what Ibn Jarir preferred, may Allah have mercy upon him. Mujahid said, uAn-Najm (the star); the one that is in the sky."*4 * Al-Hasan and Qatadah said similarly.*5 * This is the saying that is the most obvious, and Allah knows best, for Allah the Exalted said, "S&J 4 JZ 4See you not that whoever is in the heavens and whoever is on the earth, and the sun, and the moon, and the stars, and the mountains, and the trees, and the moving creatures, and many of mankind prostrate themselves to Allah.}(22:18) Allah's statement, 111 At-Jabari 23:11. 121 At-Tabari 23 : 1 1 *31 At-Tabari 23 : 1 1 At-Tabari 23:12. >51 At-Tabari 23:12.

4 -'C, U-*b iAnd the heaven He has raised high, and He has set up the balance meaning the justice, as He said in another Ayah, ^ syc JL£ t\$J Oij tilj J&> ilndeed. We have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs, and sent down with them the Book and the balance that mankind may keep up equity.^(57:25) Allah said here, ^ \y*lv 4In order that you may not transgress the balance. meaning, He created the heavens and earth in justice and truth so that everything is founded on, and observing, justice and truth. Allah's statement, 4f£o£Ji £\$ \ iAnd observe the weight with equity and do not make the balance deficient meaning, do not cheat in the weights and measures, but rather observe justice and fairness, otiAii \j>0 iAnd iveigh with the true and straight balance. 26:182) Allah said, iAnd the earth He has put down (laid) for Al-Ana'm Allah raised the heavens and put down, or laid, the earth and balanced it with firm mountains, so that it would be stable for its residents that live on it, i.e. the various types and kinds of creatures, different in species, shape, color and language. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said that Al-An'&m means the creatures. m At-Jabari 23:15-16.

iTherein arefruits,\$ ofvarious colors, taste and scent, f ifi jIQ} iand date palms producing Akmam . } Allah mentioned the date tree here specifically because of its benefit, both fresh and dry. Ibn Jurayj reported that Ibn 'Abbas said said Al-Akmdm, means sheathed fruit stalks. Similar was said by more than one of the scholars of Tafsir, it refers to the stalks that the seeds grow in to become a cluster of dates, unripe green dates then they ripen and ripen more. Allah said, 4And also com, with (its) 'Asf, and Rayhan 'Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn 'Abbas said that in, 4And also com, ivith (its) 'As/},

'Asf means straw.'*2 * Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "Asf is green leaves cut from the stem, so it is called 'Asf when it dries out."*3 ' Similarly, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and Abu Malik said that 'Asf means straw.*4 ' Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others said that Rayhan means leaves,*5 ' while Al-Hasan said that it means sweet-scented plants.*6' 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said that Rayhan means green leaves.*7' The meanings here, and Allah knows best, are the various crops that produce straw, such as wheat and barley, and Rayhan are the leaves that grow on the stems. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :693 ' At-Tabari 23:18. ' At-Tabari 23: 18. ' At-Tabari 23:18. ' At-Tabari 23:19. > Al-Baghawi 4:268. ' At-Tabari 23:21.

381 Surah 55. Ar-Rahman (14-25) (Part-27) Mankind is surrounded by Allah's Favors Allah said, 4 'T > l}!jjSo 3*\$3} 4 Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} meaning, "O mankind and Jinn, which of the favors that Allah has given to you do you deny?" Mujahid and others said this, and it is apparent when one reads what comes after it. Meaning the favors that are obvious to you while you are surrounded by them, you cannot deny or reject them. So we say, just as the believers among the Jinns said, "O Allah! None of Your favors do we deny. All praise is due to You." Ibn 'Abbas used to say, "Nay, our Lord!" meaning, "None of Your favors do we deny." &p3& & JL3 4« (&£ 3 *£s iSy 3 \$1 U-JciQi v Qpt eg, ®guL' {it \$3 j& 4 c&iii ffd % iU JjCpij 414. He created man from sounding clay like the clay of pottery.} 415. And the Jinn He created from a smokeless flame of fire.} 416. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 417. The Lord of the two easts and the Lord of the two wests.} 418. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 419. He has Maraja the two seas meeting together.} 420. Between them is a barrier which none of them can transgress.} 421 . Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} m At-Tabari 23 :23

ill. Out of them both come out pearls and Al-Marjan . \$ 423 . Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} i24. And His are Al-Jawar Al-Munsha'dt, in the seas like A'lam.} <25. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} The Creation of Humans and Jinns Allah mentions that He created mankind from clay, like that used in pottery, and created the Jinns from the tip of the flame of a smokeless fire. This was said by Ad-Dahhak from Ibn 'Abbas.' ' It was also said by Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Ibn Zayd.'2 ' Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "From the best part of the fire, from its smokeless flame."*3 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah said that Allah's Messenger jg said, ^ JA y jUJl Q>-j ijy y cJ!>- uThe angels were created from light, the Jinns from a smokeless flame of fire, and 'Adam from what was described to yoH.»'4' Muslim also collected this HadithJ5 Allah's statement: iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} was explained above. Allah is the Lord of the Two Easts and the Two Wests Allah said, 4 vyj I 1 ' At-Tabari 23:26. 121 At-Tabari 23:27. [3] A Matabari 23:26. '4 ' Ahmad 6:168. 151 Muslim 4 :2294

i(He is) the Lord of the two easts and the Lord of the two wests.} meaning the sunrise of summer and winter and the sunset of summer and winter. Allah said in another Ayah, -fj 4 So, I swear by the Lord of all the points of sunrise and sunset in the east and the west>(70:40), referring to the different places from which the sun rises and then sets on people every day. Allah said in another Ayah, t '4 V iThe Lord of the east and the west; none has the right to be worshipped but He. So take Him alone as a trustee.} (73:9), referring to the different places of sunrise and sunset and the benefits that this variation brings to the created, mankind and Jinns, i : ,Ve iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?}

Allah created Different Types of Water Allah said, {He has Maraja the two seas}, or let them loose, according to Ibn ‘Abbas. Allah’s statement, {meeting together.} Ibn Zayd said, “He prevents them from meeting by the dividing barrier He placed between them to separate them.”¹²¹ The two seas are the fresh and salty waters, the former coming from running rivers. We discussed this topic in Surat Al-Furqan when explaining Allah’s statement; “si/ wy. J»»-j ^1*1 csJJ’ it ‘i& At-Tabari 23 :29 At-Tabari 23:31.

384 Tafsir Ibn Kathir {And it is He Who has let free the two seas : one palatable and sweet, and the other salty and bitter; and He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} (25:53) Allah said, {Behveen them is a barrier which none of them can transgress.} meaning, He has placed a barrier of land between these two types of waters, so that they do not transgress upon each other, which would spoil the characteristics they were created with. Allah said, {Juf is* £S> iOut of them both come out pearls and Al-Marjan .} pearls are well-known. As for Marjan they say it means small pearls. Mujahid, Qatadah, Abu Ruzayn, Ad-Dahhak said it, and it has also been reported from ‘Ali.¹¹¹ It was also said that it means large, precious pearls, this was mentioned by Ibn Jarir from some of the Salaf. {2! Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas who said, “When it rains, the oysters in the sea open their mouths. What falls in them, the drops, turns into pearls. }3 ‘ Its chain of narrators is SahJh. Since this type of adornment is a favor from Allah to the people of earth, He reminded them of it, {4Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Allah said, {4And His are Al-Jawar Al-Munsha’dt}, meaning the ships that float, ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 23:33 and Al-Qurtubi 17:163. •2| At-Tabari 23 :34 131 At-Tabari 23 :35

385 Surah 55. Ar-Rahmdn (26-30) (Part-27) {jd\ j> iitt the seas}, Mujahid said, “Whatever ship hoists a sail, if it is from Munsha’at, if it does not hoist a sail, it is not from the Mun-sha’at’W Qatadah said, “Al-Munsha’at means created.” Others said that it is Al-Munshi’at meaning, “launched.” ilike A’lam .} This means, they are like mountains with their great size, and it also refers to the trade and commercial services they make possible, transporting cargo from one area to another. Ships provide various benefits for people, including transporting different types of goods they need. Therefore, {i&yi if* s \$oC^3 other and from one province to another iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} jli ,*, S*-4y *rj ,yu> ‘t? f 4 -. rSoC^2 L^, t^l» ib j j» u*>Vfj 4 o 426. Wlflfsoeuer is on it (the earth) will perish.} 427. And the Face of your Lord Dhul-Jalal wal-Ikram will remain forever.} ni At-Tabari 23 :37

428. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} i29. Wlwsoever is in the heavens and on the earth begs of Him . Every day He is (engaged) in some affair!} 430. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Allah is the Ever Living, Free of all Need Allah states that all the residents of earth will perish and die. The residents of the heavens will die, except whomever Allah wills. Only Allah’s Honorable Face will remain, because our Lord, the Exalted, the Blessed, is the Ever Living Who never dies. Qatadah said, “First, Allah mentioned His creatures and then He said that all of this will perish.” And in the reported supplication: ‘O You the Ever Living Who sustains all that exists! O You Who created the heavens and the earth without precedence. O You, Who Owns the glory and the honor, none has the right to be worshipped except You. We seek refuge with Your mercy. Grant Us success in all of our matters. Please, do not abandon us to rely on ourselves even for an instant nor on any of Your creation.” Ash-Sha’bi said, “When you have recited, {Whatsoever is on it (the earth) will

perish.} do not stop, continue reading, i ”- Ji 4And the Face of your Lord Dhul-Jalal wal-Ikram will remain forever.>”m This Ayah is similar to Allah’s statement, iEverything will perish save His Face.} (28:88) In this Ayah, Allah describes His Noble Face as being Dhul- Jalal wal-Ikram, indicating that He is Worthy of being revered, m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :698

and thus, never defied; and obeyed, and thus, disobeyed, ujiii never 4And keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon, seeking His Face .>(18:28), And as He said about those giving charity: q. Gi» iWefeel you seeking Allah's Face only.}{76:9) Ibn ‘Abbas commented on the meaning of Dhul-Jalal wal- Ikram, by saying, “Owner of greatness and pride.” 11 ’ After Allah stated that all of the inhabitants of the earth will die and end up in the Hereafter when He, Dhul-Jalal wal- Ikram, will judge them by His fair judgement, He said, 4ff& C&; yc \$1} 4Then which of the blessings ofyour Lord will you both deny?} Allah said, ^Whosoever is in the heavens and on the earth begs of Him. Every day He is (engaged) in some affair.} In this Ayah, Allah affirms that He is Rich, Free of all wants for anyone else and that all creatures stand in need of Him, in all conditions and situations. They all seek His help willingly or unwillingly. Everyday, He is engaged in some affair. Al-A'mash reported from Mujahid, from ‘Ubayd bin TMayr, 4ft- j fy. \$4 4Every day He is (engaged) in some affair. } He said, “Of His affairs is that He answers the supplicant, or gives to the one requesting, or removing adversity, or cures the one seeking to be cured.”2 ’ 111 At-Jabari 23 :86 121 At-Tabari 23 : 39

388 Tafsir Ibtal Kathir J ' oj . tJ,i)CjS2 LSOj £?l» (ilj 'n~oXil)' j^J ^c~*} ili irr'i.^Lij ^ ijxi V dfjRj 4-3'I-Jl _>IL3^ [(jiiT i%; tft iti su j:uj / * ££ 4iJd(^3 <33 . lA/e shall attend to you, O Thaqaldn!) 432 . Then tv/t/c/i of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 433. O assembly of Jinn and men! If you are able to pass beyond the zones of the heavens and the earth, then pass beyond (them)! But you will never be able to pass them, except with authority (from Allah)!} 434. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 435. There will be sent against you both, Shuwdz offire and Nuhds, and you will not be able to defend yourselves.} 436. Tlien which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} A Warning forHumans and Jinn Ibn Jurayj said that the Ayah, ip^ 4fNe shall attend to you,} means, “We shall judge you,’ while Al- Bukhari said that it means, “We shall recompense you. Surely, nothing will busy Allah from attending to anything else. "I1 * This type of speech pattern is common in the Arabic language. For example, one would say, “1 will attend to you,” even when one is not busy with anything else. Allah’s saying; '&} 40 you Thaqaldn!} refers to the humans and the Jinns, as in the Hadith, 111 Fath Al-Bari 8 :487

389Surah 55. Ar-Rahman (31-36) (Part-27) *Everyone will be able to hear it, except the Thaqalayn ,»[1 In another narration that explains it, the Prophet said, Allah said, «...except mankind and the Jinns. 4 tVii iThen which of the blessings of your Lord zuill you both deny?}, then, jli? j.! 4@J&i 40 assembly of Jinn and men! If you are able to pass beyond the zones of the heavens and the earth, then pass beyond (them)! But you will never be able to pass them, except with authority (from Allah)!} meaning, “you will never be able to escape Allah’s orders and decrees, because it encompasses you. You will never be able to avoid or avert His rule and judgement over you, you are surrounded by it wherever you may be.’ This is also about the Gathering when the angels, comprising seven lines in every direction, will surround the creatures. None ofthe creatures will be able to escape on that Day, if&i iexcept with

authority meaning, except with the commandment from Allah, iOn that Day man will say: “Where (is the refuge) to flee?” No! There is no refuge! Unto your Lord will be the place of rest that Day.}(75 : 10-12), Fath Al-Bari 3:244. This is no. 1338 of Al-Bukhari, about the disbeliever and the hypocrites being struck by the angels after being placed in the grave ^ The Arabic word ‘Sultan’ means power or authority

£& S; Si ^ £ a> QL> f£C- 5> v 1^ 4^ojiis-£ ->&' ifijlb£ 4J1 Si M»J*j iiiii 4AnJ //rose w/io earned evil deeds, the recompense of an evil deed is the like thereof, and humiliating disgrace will cover them. No defender ivill they have from Allah. Their faces will be covered as it were with pieces from the darkness of night. They are the dwellers of Fire, they will abide therein forever.>(10:27) Allah’s statement, iThere ivill be sent against you both, Shuwdz of fire and Niihas, and you will not be able to defend yourselves. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that Shuwdz is the flame of fire . Abu Salih said, “It is the flame above the fire below the smoke.” Ad-Dahhak said, iShuwaz offire) “A flood of fire.” Allah said; iand Niihas) ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas; “The smoke of the fire.”121 Similar was reported from Abu Salih, Said bin Jubayr and Abu Sinan . Ibn Jarir said that the Arabs used to call the smoke of the fire, Nuhas and Nihhas. But he said that the scholars of Qur’anic recitation said that in this Ayah, the word recited is Nuhas.w Mujahid said, “Molten brass poured over their heads.”151 Qatadah held the same view . Ad-Dahhak said, “Nuhas is liquid copper.” The Ayah means, ‘if you, mankind and the Jinns, try to escape on the Day of At-Tabari 23:45. At-Tabari 23:47. At-Tabari 23:47. At-Tabari 23 :48 At-Tabari 23:48. At-Tabari 23 :48

Resurrection, then the angels, including those among them who guard Hellfire, will bring you back by directing smoke of fire and molten brass on you.’ Allah’s statement, }and you ivill not be able to defend yourselves. Then which of the blessings ofyour Lord ivill you both deny?} & v sc iU uz 4 % sc 4i :k.f. £—* U jji,lu ir . 437. Then when the heaven is rent asunder, and it becomes Wardah like Dihdn .} 43S. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 439. So, on that Day he ivill not be questioned about his sin, (neither) human nor Jinn.} 440. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 447 . The criminals ivill be known by their marks, and they ivill be seized by theirforeheads and feet.} 442. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 443. This is the Hell which the criminals denied.} 444. They will go between it andHamm An!} }45. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} The Horrors ofthe Day ofResurrection Allah said, 4’.13’ oiy <>}} iThen when the heaven is rent asunder,} on the Day of Resurrection; this meaning is clear in this and similar Ayat, such as,

392 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4.V*,. Jp iClif 4And the heaven will be rent asunder, for that Day it (the heaven) ivill be frail and tom up.)(69:16). IP^^\$.pit ffin £2 <A>d (remember) the Day when the heaven shall be rent asunder with clouds, and the angels luill be sent down, with a grand descending>(25:25) and, 4:r,-2Lj <f) the heaven is split asunder, and listens to and obeys its Lord - and it must do so.^(84:1-2) Allah’s statement, iand it becomes Wardah like Dihdn .) This means they will melt just as sediment and silver are melted when heated. And they will be colored, just as dies stain something, sometimes red, sometimes yellow, or blue, or green. This demonstrates the extent of the horrors of the Mighty Day of Resurrection. As-Suddi said, “It will be as rosy color and as filth oil.” Mujahid said ir» ilike Dihdn “Like the colors of dyes.” Allah said; T*T5>oL»-%^ Jii V 4So on that Day he will not be questioned

about his sins, (neither) human nor Jinn.) this is similar to His saying; iThat ivill be a Day when they shall not speak, and they will not be permitted to putforth any excuse.^ (77:35-36) m At-Tabari 23 :50

This is the case at the time, then all the creatures will be questioned about their deeds. Allah said; d££} 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.H15:92-93) Qatadah said, “On that they will be questioned and then their mouths will be sealed and their hands and feet will reveal what they used to do.” Allah the Exalted said, <*& 42> 477ie criminals will be biown by their marks,} i.e., by special marks that distinguish them. Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, “They will be known by their dark faces and their blue eyes.”*2 ' I say that this contrasts to the marks that will distinguish the believers, such as the light that will appear on the parts of the body that they used to wash while performing ablution. Allah said, <*&%jam }and they will be seized by theirforeheads andfeet.} meaning, the angels of punishment will bend their heads down to their feet and throw them like this into the Hellfire. Al- A'mash said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “He will be taken by his forehead and his feet and be broken just as a stick is broken to be thrown into an oven.”13 Allah said, 4Tin's is the Hell which the criminals denied.} meaning, this is the Fire that you used to deny existed that it; now you see it before your eyes!’ While being chastised, criticized, disgraced and belittled, this will be said to the disbelievers. 4 . j)' m At-Tabari 23:52. 121 At-Tabari 23 :52. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :704

394 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iThey will go between it and Hamlin An!} meaning, they will sometimes be punished with fire and they will sometimes be given Hamim which is a drink like molten copper tearing their intestines and internal organs, i J3\ j i -4 jJLSff A} iWhen the iron collars will be rounded over their necks, and the chains, they shall be dragged along, in the Hamlin, then they will be burned in the Fire.>(40:71-72) Allah said if 4An} meaning hot, due to the fierce and intense heat that is impossible to bear. Ibn ‘Abbas said; j)* f* it?j iThey will go between it and Hamlin An!} “That has reached the ultimate temperature and boiling fiercely.”111 Similar was said by Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Ath-Thawri and As-Suddi.121 Qatadah also commented, “Its boiling started when Allah created the heavens and the earth!”131 Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi said, “The (disobedient) servant will be seized by the forehead and stirred in that boiling water until his flesh melts and only the bones and the eyes in his head remain. This is the meaning of Allah’s statement, iln the Hamlin, then they will be burned in the Fire.}(40:72) And Al-Hamim Al-An means hot.” There is another report from Al- Qurazi; if tf iHamlm An} that it means “prepared.” This is also the view of Ibn Zayd. 141 At-Jabari 23 :54 At-Jabari 23 :54-55 and Al-Qurtubi 17:175. At-Jabari 23 :54 •4| At-Tabari 23:55. V'

And saying that it means “prepared” does not contradict the first report from Al-Qurazi which says that it means hot, for Allah said: \$-5; &*} 4They will be given to drinkfrom a spring, Aniyah.} (88:5) which means severe unbearable heat, and His saying; jf} inot to wait for it to be prepared}!33:53) which means properly cooking and preparing it. So His saying; if- sfb iHamlm An.} Hamim, that is very hot. Surely, punishing the disobedient criminals as well as favoring those who had Taqwa, is from Allah’s grace, mercy, justice, compassion and kindness for His creatures. His warnings against His torment and punishment, such as mentioned in these Ayat, should encou- rage all creatures to abandon the Shirk and disobedience they engage in, and this is why Allah reminded them of this favor; 4;|oG£ 4Then which of the blessings ofyour Lord will you both deny?} jfc iu \$ »* •*./ ./ ,./ CHJT Uji 4 if CSoJ fiC ‘J5 446.

But for him who fears the standing before his Lord, there will be two Gardens.} 447. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 448. With Afnati.} 449. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 450. In them (both) will be two springs flowing (free).} 451 . Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?}

452. In them (both) will be every kind of fruit in pairs.} 453. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} The Delight of Those Who have Taqwa in Paradise Allah the Exalted said, 4-fv fli* J'L J4)} 4But for him who fears the standing before his Lord,} on the Day of Resurrection, 4f\$ if Jliclf Jvj} 4And restrained himself from the desires.} (79:40), and does not indulge nor prefer this worldly life. He who knows that the Hereafter is better and more lasting, so he fulfills what his Lord ordered him and stays away from His prohibitions, then he will earn two gardens from his Lord on the Day of Resurrection. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin Qays said that the Messenger of Allah said, & J <fr'j 'ji- «ISj VI (frrj > Jj Vj£ j'i Jjji "There are two gardens made of silver - their vessels and all that they contain. And there are two gardens made of gold - their vessels and all that they contain. And nothing stands between the people in the 'Adn Garden and looking at their Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, but the covering of pride before His Face, i111 The Group, with the exception of Abu Dawud, collected this via the Hadith of 'Abdul-'Aziz.121 This Ayah is general and applies to both humans and Jinns, providing proof that those among the Jinns who believe and have Taqwa will enter Paradise, for Allah is reminding the Ath- Fath Al-Bari 8 :49 1 |2) Muslim 1:163, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:232, An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 4 :419 and Ibn Majah 1 :66.

Thaqalayn of this favor, as He says; lioj 3?*" ilj ,t*~jili . "J ftu J>U- /or him who fears the standing before his Lord, there will be two Gardens. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Then He describes these two gardens, by saying, iWith Afnan .} their trees have beautiful young branches that hold and produce every type of ripened beautiful fruit, iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and several others said that Afnan means spreading branches of trees that reach the branches of other trees, in them (both) will be two springs flowing.} free to water these trees and branches that produce all kinds of fruits, 4 jS 7j\'. ~Jd} iThen which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that one of these springs is called Tasnim, and the other called As-Salsabiyah 'Atiyah said that the water of one of these springs is from non-standing water and the other from wine that gives delight to those who drink it.12 ' Allah's statement, f ot 4In them (both) will be every kind of fruit in pairs.}, of every type and kind of fruit, that which they knew before, and better, and that which they did not know before. Therein, there are delights that no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever ^ Al-Qurtubi 17:178. See Surat Al-Mutaffifin 83:27-28, and Surat Al- Insan 76:17-18. 121 Al-Qurtubi 17:178.

— Tafsir Ibn Kathir srr mmsm heard and no heart has ever imagined, ^ 3 £&\&'~<i\A'fh.{t' "'S-",' •,'*~&* iThen which of the ' blessings of your Lord *V^c/li£jp W*U you both deny?} .{' :& \ - ' Ibrahim bin Al-Hakam bin Aban said that \$gCSS&j^CsU^oQ ? is father narrated U&, _ from 'Ikrimah that LSo; «,VU<jUCfpgbo\i^J^»rj j-l^AC Ibn 'Abbas said, :ij>; "There is not a fruit > > ^ that exists in this life, OjjG'c^^ sweet or bitter, but it >rr-' T' exists in Paradise, even the colo- o^L^VCcjU© cythh "" 11 Ibn Abbas ' 'A< " * , ^ also said ' There is oL^poULy tVl*£UCpgld^ll^jj^jfv nothing in the world o0<S^;*at%kix:is *ha * u in the A ^ Hereafter except in Cp name." Meaning there —" is such an

enormous difference and contrast between the two in enjoyment and value. } 55. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Al-Qurtubi 17:179.

399 Surah 55. Ar-Rahman (54-61) (Part-27) 456. Wherein both will be Qasirdt At-Tarf, whom never deflowered a human before nor Jinn.} 457. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 458. They are like Yaqut and Marjan.} 459. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 460. Is there any reward for good other than good?} 461. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} Allah said, {Reclining}, in reference to the residents of Paradise, who will recline or sit cross-legged; {upon the couches lined with Istabraq,} which is thick silk brocade, according to 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah. Abu Imran Al-Jawni said, "It is thick silk embroidered with gold." In this way, the honor of the outside is alluded to by mentioning the honor of the inside. Abu Ishaq narrated that Hubayrah bin Yarim said that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "This is their interior, so what about it if you see their exterior?"*2 * Allah said, {and the fruits of the two Gardens will be near at hand.} close to the believers who will be able to take any of it they wish, whether they are reclining or otherwise, {The fruits in bunches whereof will be low and near at hand.}[69:23], 11 * At-Tabari 23:61 and Al-Qurtubi 17:179. * At-Tabari 23 :62

~— Tafsir Ibn Kathir {And the shade thereof is. close upon them, and the bunches of fruit thereof will hang low within their reach.}(76:14), meaning, these fruits descend from their branches to those who wish to have them, because they are close at hand, {Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} After Allah mentioned the couches, He then said. {Wherein will be}, meaning on these couches or beds, {Qasirdt At-Tarf} chaste females, wives restraining their glances, desiring none except their husbands, seeing them as the most beautiful men in Paradise. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani and Ibn Zayd. ' It was reported that one of these wives will say to her husband, "By Allah! I neither see anything in Paradise more handsome than you nor more beloved to me than you. So praise be to Allah Who made you for me and made me for you." Allah said, {iwhom never deflowered a human before nor Jinn } meaning they are delightful virgins of comparable age who never had sexual intercourse with anyone, whether from mankind or Jinns, before their husbands. This is also a proof that the believers among the Jinns will enter Paradise. Artat bin Al-Mundhir said, "Damrah bin Habib was asked if the Jinns will enter Paradise and he said, Yes, and they will get married. The Jinns will have Jinn women and the humans will have female humans."121 Allah's statement, {iwhom never deflowered a human before nor Jinn . Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} At-Tabari 23 :63 and 21 :41 ,2! At-Tabari 23 :65

401 Surah 55. Ar-Rahmdn (54-61) (Part-27) Then Allah describes these women for the proposed: {they are like Yaqit and Marfan . 4 Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Ibn Zayd and others said, "They are as pure as rubies and white as Marfan." So here they described Marfan as pearls.' Imam Muslim recorded that Muhammad bin Sirin said, "Some people either boasted or just wondered who are more in Paradise, men or women. Abu Hurayrah said, "Has not Abu Al- Qasim (Muhammad sg) said, {Verily, the first group that will enter Paradise will look like the moon when it is full, and the next batch will be as radiant as the radiant star in the sky. Each one of

them will marry two wives. The marrow of the bones of their shins will be seen through the flesh. None will be unmarried in Paradise™ This Hadxth was recorded in the Two Sahths.'3 ' Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ji ^ji i tfci Uj CjJI ^1>- -ill <J~* tft 3lja\ jij i UJ lljjjl ^jA <I>Jl fjA — — ojJ 1 14IL u oiiaij iUwj u oSt*J \ ^1 i>ji ,iy ^*3 & Uyy3 «A morning or an evening journey in Allah's cause is better than the world and whatever is on its surface. And a place in Paradise as small as that occupied by the whip of one of you, is better than the world and whatever is on its surface. If one of the women of the people of At-Jabari 23:66-67. 121 Muslim 4:2178. 131 Path Al-Bari 6:367 and 417 and Muslim 4 -.2179-2180.

' (ZfflSSs ^ Paradise looks directly at ^gC^i^;;fcU©S^3gi5sSCi the earth she wiU fiu _ .. ' ' 7, ^ .. , '~ ui/wf is between Paradise o'— and earth with a good . i" '-Ca^O' ~<s\'-V- £?, scent and all of it will , 73 become delightful. Ve- JjiiriJujJ rily, the veil over her " r-f (".><&* head is better than this ® life and all that is an Us 0 £?*' surface . »' 1 /vvr-tMU^Vi Al-Bukhari also ,JES#gp^lf collected a similar -.1 \ narration.12 ' '.jsSs**'. Allah the Exalted 4j*3,^J^v^xS_) 1jl SOid Cp V) ^.-^7 •'jpL. 0 4C|5^f ^ there anyreward for ©5g£KJ\$dp0^ioA^^^lir *** T^ 41 ^ > > Allah Hprlarpc thatj »t>jL s/s Allah declares that in the Hereafter, all ^ ^ (" .ifi&n.' that is good and Sp righteous is the only befitting reward for those who do good deeds in this life, !P3 2\$» 4For those who have done good is best (reward) and even more.i(10:26) All of these are tremendous blessings that cannot be earned merely by good deeds, but by Allah's favor and bounty, after all of these He says; , \$3 <&p iThen which of the blessings ofyour Lord will you both deny?i Ahmad 3 :141 121 FathAl-Bari 6:19.

^,o1_j sLj ^5L* Vf ^o^>- LjJ .. ^ iIjLj^aSCj * cj'k.'-Lijj 1 - |-4 . l3 , ol._A^j A , jtj\$0 LS^j tvi. iti .y*-, ol—»- , v^ jlJ Lfi> tvi. Cft .vColso 6 £• &X -j jg>4QS & {& &%M 4 X&ii? 2Avj £| &4S jJ f^W^SO m. iU ig'^UJ 4 CCy-U \$*» v.^ijA—£• j(((*A f**~ »£A> v.“jgC5Sj I\$2> *if” it iXy o£. 4 v\ fjJ^ iiC; ISCj 462 . And below these two, there are two other Gardens.} 463. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 464. Mudhammatan .} 465. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 466. In them (both) will be two springs Naddakhatan .} 467. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 468. In than (both) toill be fruits, and date palms and pomegranates.} 469. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 470. Therein (Gardens) will be Khayrdt Hisan;} 471. Thai which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 472. Hur (beautifid , fairfanales) guarded in pavilions;} 473. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 474. Wlwm never deflowered a human before nor Jinn.} 475. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 476. Reclining on green Rafrand rich beautiful 'Abqariy.} 477. Then which of the blessings of your Lord will you both deny?} 478. Blessed be the Name ofyour Lord, Dhil-Jaldli wal-Ikrdm.}

These two gardens are lower, in virtue and in status than the two before them, as supported in the Qur'an. Allah said: £rJ-> 4And below these tivo, there are two other Gardens.} We previously mentioned the Hadith stating that there are two gardens made of gold, their vessels and all they contain, and there are two gardens made of silver, their vessels and all they contain. The first two are for the near believers (Muqarribm) and the latter two are for those on the right (Ashab Al- yaminJ ' Abu Musa commented, “There are two gardens made of gold for the Muqarribln and two gardens made of silver for Ashab Al-Yamm.” There are several proofs that the former two gardens in Paradise are better in

grade than the latter. Allah mentioned the former two gardens before the latter two, thus indicating their significance, then He said, 4ly,d&r £rj> 4And below these tivo, there are two other Gardens.} And this is an obvious form of honoring the first two gardens over the latter two. Allah described the former gardens: iWith Afnan}, which are the extending branches, as we explained, or various types of delights. But He said about the latter two gardens, iMudhammatan}, being dark, because of the intense irrigation. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Mudhdmmtan means, they have become dark green because of extensive water irrigation.”¹²¹ Muhammad bin Ka*b said: iMndhamtnatdn} “Full of greenery.” There is no doubt that the former two gardens are better, their branches are fresh, FathAl-Bari 8 :491 . ¹²¹ Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7 :715 .

405Surah 55. Ar-Rahman (62-78) (Part-27 youthful and intermingling. Allah said about the former two gardens, 4In them (both) will be two springsflowing (free)), while He said about the springs of the latter two gardens, 4Naddakhatan}\ ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas: “It means gushing. And the free flowing is stronger than gush- ing.” ¹ 11 Ad-Dahhak said that, igushing forth} means, they are full of water and constantly gushing.* * Allah said about the former two gardens, 4-="oC}J jf Oi lljj ilti them (both) toill be every kind offruit in pairs}, but He said about the latter two gardens, 4 V’ Cjj} iln them (both) will be fruits, and date palms and pomegranates.} There is no doubt that the first description is better and refers to more of a variety and more types of fruit. Allah said about the latter two gardens, Allah then said; bji Uf} 4Therein zoill be Khayrdt Hisan ;} meaning, there are various types of good and delightful things in these two gardens in Paradise, according to Qatadah. It was also said that Khayrat is plural of Khayrah and it is a righteous, well-mannered, beauti- ful woman, according to the majority of scholars, and it is also reported from Umm Salamah as a Hadith from the Prophet Sg. There is another Hadith saying that Al-Hur Al-'Ayn will sing, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 7:716. At-Tabari 23:357. At-Tabari 23 :75.

““We are Al-Khayrat Al-Hisan, we were created for honorable husbands.”n’ Allah said: iHur (beautiful, fairfemales) guarded in pavilions;} but He said about the first two gardens, A’jfa ^>-4 inff} iWherein both will be Qdsirdt At-Tarf,} There is no doubt that the chaste wives that restrain their glances themselves, are better than those guarded in pavilions even though both are secluded. About Allah’s saying: tin pavilions;} Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Qays said that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, < ^s- 1 Ojy. t* >• J* 1 « Verily , in Paradise, the believer will have a tentfrom a hollow pearl, the width thereof is sixty miles. In each comer of it there are wives for the believer that do not see the other wives, and the believer will visit them «//.»’²¹ In another narration the Prophet sg said that this tent is thirty miles wide.*³ ‘ Muslim recorded this Hadith and in his narration, the Prophet jg said, l "jt-J j C—. UJ lii jp p (.<i«; {Sji 'fc j-V *-~jl*i <J*’ ^Verily in Paradise, the believer will have a tent made of a Iwllow pearl the length thereof being sixty miles. In it, the believer will have wives who do not see each other, and the believer will visit them At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat 7 :257. ¹²¹ Fath Al-Bari 8 :49 1 131 Fath Al-Bari 6:366.

407Surah 55. Ar-Rahmdn (62-78) (Part-27) allj’¹¹ Allah the Exalted said, itc% iWItom never were deflowered by a human before nor Jinn> We explained this meaning before. Allah added in the description of the first group of the believers’ wives, 4-f. iU oyCi’ ^ 4they are like Yaqut (rubies) and Marjan (pearls). Then which of the blessings ofyour Lord will you both deny?} Allah said, 4Reclining

on green Rafrat and rich beautiful Abqariy .} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "Rafrat means cushions."¹²¹ Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and others also said that Rafrat means cushions .²¹ Al-'Ala' bin Badr said: "The Rafrat are arrayed hanging over the couches." Allah's statement. and rich beautiful Abqariy.} Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said that 'Abqariy means rich carpets .⁴¹ Allah said, 4Blessed be the Name of your Lord (Allah) Dhal-Jalal wal- Ikram,} Allah states that He is Worthy of being honored and always obeyed, revered and thus worshipped, appreciated and never unappreciated, and remembered and never forgotten. 'Abdullah bin 'Abbas said that, Muslim 4 :2182. At-Tabari 23:83. At-Tabari 23:84. [4) At-Tabari 23:85.

4Phil-Jalal wal-Ikram means, the Owner of greatness and pride. ! In a Hadith, the Prophet said, jlyiJl J (ji Still ,_ \$j Jvk£-J 'ot Ol» • Verily, among the acts of venerating Allah, are honoring the elderly Muslims, the one in authority, and carrier (memorizer) of the Qur'an who avoids extremism and laziness with it." Imam Ahmad recorded that Rabl'ah bin 'Amir said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, "Persist (in invoking Allah) with, "Yd Dhal-Jalal wal-Ikram (O Owner of greatness and honor),"»³ An-Nasa'i also collected this Hadith)⁴ Muslim and the Four Sunan compilers recorded that 'A'ishah said, "When the Messenger of Allah jg would (say the) Salam (completing prayer), he would only sit as long as it takes him to say, «0 Allah! You are As-Salim, and peace comes from You. Blessed be You Yd Dhal-Jalal wal-Ikram . »."»⁵¹

Surah 56: Al-Waqiah

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The Virtues of Surat Al-Waqiah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5693–5697]

Abu Ishaq reported from 'Ikrimah from Ibn 'Abbas that Abu Bakr said, "O Allah's Messenger! You are becoming gray?" The Messenger replied, "—'jjS —L-lJl lip "^c-j Uipjp «Hud (chapter 11), Al-Waqi'ah (56), Al-Mursaldt (77), 'Ammā Yatasa'aliin (78) and Idha Ash-Shamsu Kuivwirat (81) have made me gray. At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith and said, "Hasan Gharib." In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. e czJ* 4:^ &4\& !A7ien the Waqi'ah occurs 42. There is not, for its occurrence, Kadhilah.} 43. Bringing low (some), exalting (others).} 44. When the earth will be shaken with a terrible shake.} 45. And the mountains will be pmvdered to dust,} 46. So that they will becomefloating dust particles.} 47. And you (all) will be in three groups .} m Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 : 184

48. So those on the right - hoiv (fortunate) zwill be those on the right!} 49. And those on the left - how (unfortunate) will be those on the left!} 410. And thoseforemost will beforemost.} 411. These will be the nearest (to Allah).} 422. In the Gardens ofDelight.} The Horrors ofthe Day ofResurrection Al-Waqi'ah (the occurrence), is one of the names of the Day of Resurrection, because that Day is real and will surely come. Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat, Up** *3; j 4Then on that Day shall the Waqi'ah occur.}{ 69:15) Allah the Exalted said, i -vX* £} 4There is not, for its occurrence, Kadhilah. } means, when He commands the Day of Resurrection to begin, none can stop it from happening or prevent it from beginning, }y. J Jt ^ 4Answer the call of your Lord before there comes from Allah a Day which can not be averted.} (42:47), ' cj' 4 O-? 4A questioner asked concerning a torment about to occur - upon the disbelievers, which none can avert.}(70:1-2), ^ 4& % 53% & &} fa@% 4And on the Day He will say: "Be!" - and it is! His Word is the Truth. His ivill be the dominion on the Day when the Trumpet will be blown. All-Knower of the unseen and the seen. He is the All-Wise, Well Aware.}{6:73) As for the meaning of

iKadhilah} Muhammad bin Ka*b said: "It will certainly occur," while Qatadah said, "It shall not be discontinued, taken back or aborted." Allah's statement, 4 - ^ 4Bringing low, exalting indicates that Al-Waqi'ah lowers some people to the lowest parts of the Fire, even if they had been mighty in this life. It also elevates others to the highest grades in the residence of eternal delight, even if they were weak in this life. This was said by Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others.¹²¹ Al- 'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas: 4Bringing low, exalting}, "It made the near and the far hear it," while 'Iknmah said, "It lowered, and thus those who were close heard it, and elevated, and thus those in the distance heard it." Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said similarly. Allah said, iWhen the earth will be shaken with a terrible shake.} meaning, it is shaken and moved violently over all of its surface and through its depths. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid,

Qatadah and others said about Allah's saying: {i}Whai the earth will be shaken with a terrible shake.} it means "Violently shaken."¹³¹ Ar-Rabi' bin Anas said, "The earth will be shaken with all that is in it, just as a sifter is shaken with its contents." This is like Allah's saying: {i}When the earth is shaken with its earthquake.}[99:1] and, At-Tabari 23:89. 121 At-Tabari 23:90. At-Tabari 23:91.

412 TafsTr Ibn Kathir iijj |*6=oj i^ijf Jj3\ 40 mankind! Have Taqioa ofyour Lord! Verily, the earthquake of the Hour is a terrible thing.}[22:1). Allah said: 4And the mountains will be powdered to dust,} meaning, relentlessly pulverized. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah and Qatadah and others.' 11 Ibn Zayd said: "The mountains will becomejust like Allah described them, 4A heap of sand poured out.>(73: 14). ""2| Allah's saying: 4So that they will become floating dust particles.> Abu Ishaq narrated from Al-Harith, from 'Ali: "It will become like the rising dust storm that soon fades away leaving no trace of itself behind." Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas about Allah's saying: 4So that they will becomefloating dust particles .> "It describes the rising embers from the fire when it is kindled, but when the embers land, they are extinguished quickly."*3 ' 'Ikrimah said, "The floating dust particles that the wind scatters all around," while Qatadah said, 4floating particles>, "Like the dry parts of trees that the wind scatters all about." This Ayah is similar to several other Ayat that indicate that the mountains will be moved from their places, demolished and blown off their bases, becoming like 111 At-Tabari 23:92, 93. 121 At-Tabari 23:93. 131 At-Tabari 23:94.

carded wool on the Day of Resurrection. Three Categories ofPeople on the Day ofResurrection Allah's statement, 4And you (all) will be in three groups. This means that people will be divided into three categories on

the Day of Resurrection. Some will on the right of Allah's

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5697-5743]

Throne, and they are those who were brought forth from 'Adam's right side.' ' This category will be given their Books of Records in their right hand and will be taken to the right side. As-Suddi explained that they will comprise the majority of the residents of Paradise. Another category is those who will be placed to the left of Allah's Throne, and they are those who were brought forth from 'Adam's left side. This category will be given their Books of Records in their left hands and will be taken to the left side. They are the residents of the Fire, may Allah save us from their actions. A third category is comprised of those who are the foremost and nearest before Allah. They are in a better grade and status and nearer to Allah than those on the right side. They are the chiefs of those on the right side, because they include the Messengers, Prophets, true believers and martyrs. They are fewer than those on the right side; so Allah said, 11 u 4So those on the right - how will be those on tlie right! And those on the left - how will be those on the left! And those foremost will beforemost. Allah divides people into these three groups upon their death, as indicated by the end of this Sarah. Allah mentioned them in His statement as well, rrp [il See the narration ofAbu Dharr, no. 349 of Al-Bukhari , and it was mentioned in volume five , in the beginning of the Tafsir of Surat Al- Isra'.

/c-j * * < ** »> ^ 4Then We gave the Book as inheritance to such ofOur servants whom We chose. Then of them are some ivho wrong themselves, and of them are some who follow a middle course, and

of them are some who are, by Allah's leave, foremost in good deeds. >(35:32) Muhammad bin Ka'b, Abu Hazrah Ya'qub bin Mujahid said that, 4And those foremost will be foremost.} is about the Prophets, peace be upon them,¹¹¹ while As-Suddi said that they are the residents of the utmost highs (Ahl Al-'Uyyin, in Paradise).

The meaning of foremost is that they were foremost in performing the acts of righteousness just as Allah commanded them, iAnd march forth in the way to forgiveness from your Lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth.}[3: 133] and, dl. }Race with one another in hastening towards forgiveness from your Lord, and Paradise the width whereof is as the width of the heaven and the earth.>(57:21) Therefore, those who rush to obey Allah in this life and are foremost in performing acts of righteousness, will be among the foremost believers honored in the Hereafter. Verily, the reward is according to the kind of deed, and as one does, so he is judged. So Allah said: iThese will be the nearest (to Allah). In the Gardens of Delight.} \$\$\$&&? /r \$ oj \$JSj 0\$ m Al-Qurtubi 17 : 199

415 Surah 56. Al-Waqi'ah (13-26) (Part-27) _ ^ [^e- jyu^v V ^ ^v j'-jj O^Ju V .yy jd» rlr• tJ L-i— Vi Tj vLJj 'Jj V i?t .:i»jU« ^K** Uj .r>- 4 , 'n'CLl <23. A multitude of those will be from the first ones .} <24. And a /en; of those will be from the later ones.} 415. (They will be) on thrones, Mawdutiya.} <26. Reclining thereon, face to face.} 417. Immortal boys will go around them (serving),} <28. With cups, and jugs, and a glass of flowing wine,} <29. Wherefrom neither Yusadda'un nor Yunziffm.} <20. And with fruit that they may choose.} <22 . And with the flesh of fowls that they desire.} <22. And (there will be) Hur with wide lovely eyes.} <23. Like preserved pearls.} 424. A reward for what they used to do.} <25. No Laghio (evil vain talk) will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech.} 426. But only the saying of: "Salaman! Salaman!"} The Reward of the Foremost in Faith Allah states that the foremost of the close believers are a multitude, a crowd among the earlier generations and a few from the latter generations. There is a difference over the meaning of the first generations and the later generations. Some said that the former means earlier (believing) nations, while the later refers to this Ummah. This was reported from Mujahid and Al-Hasan Al-Basri, in the collection of Ibn Abi Hatim, and this is the preference of Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ He considered it supported by the saying of Allah's Messenger sg: m At-Tabari 23 :98

416 Tafstr Ibn Kathir «We are the later nation, but the foremost on the Day of Resurrection .»¹ Ibn Jarir did not mention any other interpretation nor did he attribute this view to anyone else. There is another Hadith that could support this meaning. Imam Abu Muhammad bin Abi Ijatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that when these Ayat were revealed, iA multitude of those (foremost) will be from the first ones. And a few of those will be from the later ones .^, this news became hard for the Companions of the Prophet These this Ayat, Si yij iA multitude of those will be from the first ones. And a multitude of those will be from the later ones.}, were revealed. The Prophet jg then said, ' J' J'P 4>Jl ~ «/ hope that you will comprise a quarter of the residents of Paradise, a third of the residents of Paradise. Rather, you are a half of the residents of Paradise, and will have a share in the other half.v Imam Ahmad also recorded this .²¹ However, this opinion that Ibn Jarir chose is questionable, rather it is a deficient interpretation. This is because this Ummah is the best of all nations, according to the text of the Qur'an. Therefore, it is not possible that the foremost believers from earlier nations are more numerous than

those of in this Ummah; the opposite is true. The latter opinion is the correct one, that, Si iA multitude of those will befrom the first ones}. 111 Path Al-Bari 11 :526. Ahmad 2:391.

427Surah 56. Al-Wdqi'ah (13-26) (Part-27) refers to the earlier generations of this Ummah, while, i 3ij> iAnd afew of those will befrom the later ones.}, refers to the latter people of this Ummah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that As-Sari bin Yahya said that Al- Hasan recited this Ayah, iAnd those foremost will befrom the first ones.}, Then he commented, "A multitude from the earlier generation of this Ummah." Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded that Muhammad bin Sirin commented: iA multitude of those will befrom the first ones. And afew of those will befrom the later ones.}, "They stated, or hoped that they will all be from this Ummah." Therefore, these are the statements of Al-Hasan and Ibn Sirin that those foremost in faith are all from this Ummah. There is no doubt that the earlier generations of each nation were better than the latter generations. In this pretext, this Ayah might include all previous believing nations. In this regard, it is confirmed in the authentic Hadith compilations, from more than one route, that the Messenger of Allah said; 6*^* p 'JiA A*- eThe best people are my generation, then the next generation, then the next generation n* 1 ' He also said: °4pLUI «A group ofmy Ummah will always remain on the truth and m Al-Bukhari no. 3651

i *yj^j iWith cups, and jugs, and a glass offlowing wine} these cups do not have handles or spouts, while the jugs sometimes do and sometimes do not. All of them, including the glasses, will contain wine drawn from a flowing spring, not from containers that might get empty. Rather, this spring of wine flows freely, j>ji jj V* Vy iWherefrom neither Yusadda'un nor Yunzifun .} meaning, they will never get headaches from this wine nor intoxicated. Rather, this wine does not affect their minds, even though it has a strong and tremendously delightful taste. Ad- Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "The wine (of this life) has four side-effects, it intoxicates, gives headaches, induces vomiting and causes excessive urine. So Allah mentioned the wine of Paradise free of these characteristics."111 Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, Qatadah and As- Suddi said that Allah's statement, iy^ ^} iWherefrom neither Yusadda'un} means, "It does not give them a headache."121 While they said that iM %~} inor will they Yunzifun.} means that "It does not change then- sense of reasoning."131 Allah's statement, iAnd with fruit that they may choose. And with the flesh of fowls that they desire.} meaning, whatever fruits they wish for will be distributed among them. This Ayah is a proof that we are allowed to choose the fruits that we prefer and wish to eat. Al-Qurtubi 17:203. At-Tabari 23:103, 104. At-Tabari 23:104, 105.

Imam Ahmad recorded that Thabit said that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah jfe liked dreams. A man might have a dream, so he would ask about him if he did not know him, and would like to hear the dream if that man was praised for his good qualities. Once a woman came to him and said, "O Allah's Messenger! I had a dream that I was taken out of Al- Madlnah and entered Paradise. I heard noise because ofwhich Paradise wept. I looked and found so-and-so, so-and-so,' and she mentioned the names of twelve men whom the Prophet jg had sent with a militaiy expedition. They were later brought on (in Paradise, in the dream) with their wounds still bleeding. It was said, Take them to the river Baydakh or - Baydhakh.' They were taken to that river and submerged in it and their faces turned as radiant as the full moon. They were brought a plate made of gold containing green dates. They ate as much of the

green dates they wanted to and whenever they turned that plate around, they would eat from the fruit it contained, as much as they wanted, and I (the woman said) ate with them.” Later on, that army sent an emissary to convey the news (of the battle) and he said that so-and-so and so-and-so died, mentioning the names of the twelve men who were mentioned in the dream. So, Allah’s Messenger jg called the woman and again asked her to mention her story, and she did. This is the narration that Abu Yala collected, ' and Al-Hafiz Ad-Diya' said, “This Hadith meets the criteria of Muslim.” Allah said, 4And with the flesh offowls that they desire. > Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Jt'J-'f. icJJl Jliife *LJl> «Birds of Paradise are like Bukht camels^ that graze in the trees of Paradise .» Abu Bakr commented, “O Allah’s Messenger! Surely, these birds must be wonderful.” The Messenger jg said, 111 Ahmad 3 :135, and Musnad Abu Ya'ld 6 :44. ' A species of camel with a very long neck. See An-Nihayah.

“Those who eat them are more wonderful .» and repeated this statement thrice. The Prophet went on, iij& j' je'j'l J>j “And I hope that you will be among those who eat from them.»<" J Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith using this chain of narration. Allah said; ilike unto preserved pearls>, indicating that they are just as white and pure fresh pearls. We mentioned Allah’s statement, 4As if they were eggs preserved.\$(37 :49), in SurafAs-SaZ/df(chapter37),and also their description in SuratAr- Rahman (chapter 55). This is why Allah said afterwards, iA reward for what they used to do> meaning, ‘these delights that We granted them are rewards for the good deeds that they performed (in this life).’ Allah the Exalted said, £f\$2Ll vu> yi S4 % £>£ iNo Laghw (evil vain talk) will they hear therein , nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: "Saldman (peace,)! Salaman (peace,)!"} meaning they will not hear foul or unnecessary speech in Paradise. Q 'e^ iWhere they shall neitlier hear harmful speech nor falsehood (88 :11), meaning, no foul words are uttered therein. Allah said, iM Ahmad 3 :221

422 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr %mm aro mmz £j%Z\ 'ij^ji^dyClj^^oJOU\s&£> 4^V^0^a^0at- 0?y^gk-J^ 'i/j ^yjCli ^ Siji\$0 n^j irfr^i\jJ^j^" ^Ql- %} 4nor any sinful speech .} meaning, nor speech that contains foul words, £L yj ^[] 4Bnf only the saying of: "Saldman (peace!), Sala- man (peace!)."} , they will greet each other with Salam, just as Allah said in another Ayah, iTheir greeting therein will be: "Saldman (peace!)."} (14:23) And, as we mentioned, their words will be free from impure and needless speech. •, / ^ > ; , ; / <Si\ >*i * . 4Sn ^ff > ^»f tv > -'l-v qM» ^V? 4 yXiy!iJ' v^' C vte? v^!»r CHP^ %\$\$\$* *A> Vj ^ ^)p£ >"Cj yij dSi * & ^vj4?> Oi 427. And those on the right - how (fortunate) will be those on the right?} 428. (They will be) among Sidri Makhdud,} 429. And among Talh Mandud.} 430. And in slmde Mamdud,} 431 . And by waterflowing constantly,} 432. And fruit in plenty,}

423Sura)j 56. Al-Waqi'ah (27-40) (Part-27) 433. Whose supply is not ait offnor are they out of reach.4 434. And on couches, raised high.} 435. Verily, We have created them a special creation.} 436. And made them virgins.} 437. ‘Urub, Atrab.} 438. For those on the right.} 439. A multitude of those will befrom thefirst generation.} 440. And a multitude of those will be from the later generations.} The Reward ofThose on the Right After Allah mentioned the final destination of those foremost in faith, the nearest to Him, He next mentioned the end of those on the right, the righteous believers. Maymun bin Mihran said that those on the right side are lesser in rank than the foremost in faith. Allah said, 4 u jwii z£^ \} 4And those on the right - how (fortunate) will be those on the right?} who are those on the right, what is their condition and what will their final destination be like? Allah next answers this question by

saying, i fri 3} 4(they will be) among Sidr Makhduḍ.} Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ibn Al-Aḥwas, Qasamah bin Zuhayr, As-Safr bin Nusayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, ‘Abdullah bin Kathīr, As-Suddi, Abu Hazrah and several others said, “The kind without thorns.”¹¹¹ And from Ibn ‘Abbas: “It is the one that is laden with fruits.” This is also reported from Ikrimah and Mujahid. Similar was also said by Qatadah as we mentioned. So it is the one with a full load of fruits without thorns. So it appears that both meanings apply here. The lote tree, of this life is thorny and carries few fruits. In the Hereafter, it is the opposite; it does not have thorns and carries plenty of fruit, the weight of m At-Jabari 23 : 1 10

424 Tafstr Ibn Kathir which strains its trunk. “Utbaḥ bin ‘Abd As-Sulami said, “I was sitting with Allah’s Messenger ḡ, when a bedouin came and said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Have you heard about the tree that has more thorns than any other being in Paradise?’ Meaning the Talḥ tree. So Allah’s Messenger ḡ said: ḡḡ 4 , ,1 V “For each spot that there was a thorn on it, Allah instead put fruit, similar to a castrated tight skinned ram, a food having seventy colors, each different than the other. d1 ’ 1 Allah’s said, 4 AV 4and among Talḥ Mandud refers to large thorny shrub that used to grow in the area of Hijaz (Western Arabia). Mujahid said that iMandiḍ} means: “Its fruits are piled on top of each other. Allah is reminding the Quraysh of these kinds of trees, since they used to like the shade that the Talḥ and Sidr provided for them.”¹²¹ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Saḍ said that iTalḥ Mandud means: “The banana tree.” And he (Ibn Abi Hatim) said, “Similar is reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, Abu Hurayr- ah, Al-Hasan, Ikrimah, Qasamah bin Zuhayr, Qatadah and Abu Hazrah.”¹³¹ Mujahid and Ibn Zayd said similalry, Ibn Zayd added, “The people of Yemen call the banana tree, Talḥ . Ibn Jarir mentioned no other explanation for Talḥ. Allah said, Al-Ba’tḥ by Ibn Abi Dawud, 94, At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat, no. 402. Similar was recorded by Ahmad 4:183 which follows shortly, and Ibn Abi ‘Asim in As-Sunnah no. 716. See also Al-Majma’no. 18727. At-Tabari 23:114. 131 At-Tabari 23:112, 113. 141 At-Tabari 23:113.

iAnd in shade Mamduḍ (extended).) Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet ḡ said, •(*--? ’ḡḡ 1 V fli- «5U 44’^’ jrri 5! “In Paradise, there is a tree that a rider can travel for a hundred years under its sḡuḍe but would not be able to pass it. Recite if you will: iAnd in shade extended.)^ Muslim also collected this Hadith.¹² Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ḡ said, • (*~4 ḡ| biyl ^Ip «3l • > iThere is a tree in Paradise the shade of which a rider would take one hundred years to pass. Recite if you will: iAnd in shade extended>» Muslim,¹⁴¹ Al-Bukhari¹⁵¹ and ‘Abdur-Razzaḡ¹⁶¹ collected this Hadith. Allah said. }ḡḡḡḡm iAnd fruit in plenty, whose supply is not cut off nor are they out of reach.) indicating that they will have plenty of fruits of various kinds, that which no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard of and no heart has ever imagined, as Allah said, 4 1 iyij ḡ4* at iSijJ Ixl ijJli I/O \ iEvery time they will be provided with a fruit therefrom, they 111 Fath Al-B&ri8 :495 Muslim 4:2175. Ahmad 2 :482 Muslim 4 :2175. |s| Fath Al-Bari 6 :368 ‘Abdur-Razzaḡ 1 1 :4 17

•Have you traveled to Ash-Sham area? The bedouin said: ‘No.’ The Prophet ḡ said, U&f JLi ^ip eJḡ ḡ^ḡ; If *It looks like a tree that grows in Ash-Sham area and is called Al-Jawzah, which stands on one stem but its brandies grow all around to the fullest extent .» The bedouin asked, ‘How big is the cluster of its fruits?’ The Prophet ḡ said, “The distance that the crow flies in one month without rest. The bedouin asked, ‘How huge its trunk is?’ The Prophet ḡ said, “liḡA ’ḡ-& ḡi- i l\$U»t 1 U illii Jil Cr! <///a four-year old she-camel that your family owns travels it, it will not completely pass its trunk until its

shoulders break from old age. The man asked, 'Does it bear grapes?' The Prophet ﷺ answered in yes. The bedouin asked, 'How big are the grapes?' The Prophet ﷺ said, 'J?L-lipU ^»ip Lllj il^il Jjit 'Has your father ever slaughtered a ram? The bedouin answered, 'Yes,' and the Prophet ﷺ asked him, '-o 0 : JU* Jiii olkpti «JUj ^Jl: 'And then he skinned it and gave the skin to your mother and asked her to make a hanging bucket out of it? The bedouin again said yes and said, 'This grape would suffice for me and my family!' The Prophet ﷺ agreed and said, 'Yes, and also for the rest of your clan,a"111 m Ahmad 4:183.

Allah's statement, 4 Iff Vj icjiiii ~)} iWhose supply is not cut off nor are they out of reach.} The supply of these fruits never runs out, winter or summer. Rather, they are always available for those who want to eat from them, forever. Whenever these fruits are desired, they will be available and easy to grasp by Allah's power. Qatadah said, "Nothing will prevent them from reaching out to get these fruits, no branches, thorns or distance."111 We mentioned a Hadith before that states that whenever someone takes a fruit in Paradise, another one grows in its place. Allah said, afterwards: iAnd on couches, raised high.} meaning, high, soft and comfortable. Allah said, iTxCi) ijt- "ffz ^ iVerily, We have created them a special creation. And made them virgins. 'Urub, Atrab. For those on the right.} The Ayat describe the women who will be on the beds and couches, but since mentioning the beds hints to them, they were not directly mentioned. For instance, Allah said that Sulayman said, Cf- v-* U* jtSi LrMCli hSlrf s?- * > i EiX C>Jj iWhen there were displayed before him, in the afternoon, well- trained horses of the highest breed. He said, "I did love the good instead of remembering my Lord," till the time was over, and it had hidden in the veil (of night).} (38:31-32), "it" (Tawdrat) refers to the sun setting, according to the scholars of Tafsir. Al-Akhfash said that Ayah, iVerily, We have created them}, implied the maidens of Paradise m At-Tabari 23 : 1 18

429 Surah 56. Al-Wdqi'ah (27-40) (Part-27) although it did not mention them directly. 1 11 Abu 'Ubaydah said that they were mentioned before in Allah's statement. 4 And Hiir (fair females) with i vide lovely eyes. Like preserved pearls.} l2] Therefore, Allah's statement, iVerily, We have created them}, meaning, in the other life, after they became old in this life, they were brought back while virgin, youthful, being delightfully passionate with their husbands, beautiful, kind and cheerful. Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Anas said that the Messenger of Allah said, IJSj ljs J «/n Paradise, the believer will be given such and such strength for women. Anas said, "I asked, 'O Allah's Messenger! Will one be able to do that?' He said, «j5L. «He will be given the strength of a hundred (men)."" At-Tirmidhi also recorded it and said, "Sahih Ghanb.i4] Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was asked, "O Allah's Messenger! Will we have sexual intercourse with our wives in Paradise?" He said, CX, j>\ pdl Jt jjo "The man will be able to have sexual intercourse with a hundred virgins in one day.d51 At-Tabari 23:118. At-Tabari 23:118. Musnad At-Tayalisi 269 [4] Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :24 1 ,s| At-Tabarani in As-Saghlr 2 :68.

Al-Hafiz Abu 'Abdullah Al-Maqdisi said, "In my view, this Hadith meets the criteria of the Sahih, and Allah knows best." Allah's statement, i'Urub,} Said bin Jubayr reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "They are in an infatuated state with their husbands, haven't you ever seen a she-camel in heat? She is like that." Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas who said, "The Urub and their husbands are their sweet hearts, and they are their husbands' sweet hearts." !11 Similar was said by 'Abdullah bin Saijis, Mujahid,

'Ikrimah, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Yahya bin Abi Kathir, 'Atiyah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and others.¹²
 * Ad- Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas; iAtrab}, means "They will be of one age, thirty-three years old."¹³ ' Mubahid said, "Equal (age)." And in a different narra- tion, "Similar (age)."^{*4} ' Atiyah said, "Comparative." Allah said, \$For those on the right .^ meaning, these women were created, kept or given in marriage to those on the right. It appears that the meaning here is that they were created for those on the right side, because Allah said. iVerily, We have created them a special creation. And made them virgins. 'Urub, Atrab. For those on the right. } This is the view of Ibn Jarir.¹⁵ * It is possible that Allah's statement, iFor those on the right.} refers to the description that came just ** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :16 At-Tabari 23:121, 122, 123. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8:16. * At-Tabari 23:24. ' At-Tabari 23:125.

431 Surah 56. Al-Wdci'ah (27-40) (Part-27) before, iAtrab. For those on the right.} meaning, in their age. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messen- ger of Allah jg said, ir* ilM ijidi &} jliSl sjjJ, JLZ ioJi \yj Jji 'ij tjil&j Vj * Ltjbyizj 'ij i ofifj V iHLe>\ »U_LJi jLii iJlJl 1 -*.^' iJlziJjj 'ji. ^j jfj jU ^}%i\ @s-ULUl tEljS «77ie first group to enter Paradise will be (shining) like the moon when it is full. The next group will be like the most radiant planet in the sky. They will not urinate, relieve nature, spit or blow their noses. Their combs will be of gold and their sweat of musk; and censers of aloeswood will be used. Their wives will befrom Al-Hur Al-Ayn. Their shape will be similar to each other, the shape of theirfather 'Adam, sixty cubits high in the sky. d' Allah's statement, 4A multitude of those will be from the first generation. And a multitude of those will befrom the later generations.} means, a multitude of those on the right will come from the earlier generations and a multitude from the latter generations. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas"ud said, "We were with the Prophet sg one night and in the next morning we went to him and he said. ij. ur^j Ifo" ' £ £JS?I ^iU ' "fr <J>-i fjfiJ tElk«Jl "Some Prophets and their nations were displayed before me. A Prophet would pass in front of me with a group of men, and m Fath Al-Bari 6:417, Muslim 4:2179.

432 Tafslr Ibn Kathir another with three men, and another with nobody with him.» Qatadah, one of the narrators of the Hadith, then recited this Ayah, ils there not among you a single right-minded man?^(1 1:78) "J j?. jt jt oYM If. It*)* t} «Until Musa, son of 'Imran passed me, with a great crowd from the Children of Israel . » So he said; ori Iri **f iji :3i J* tS-J : JV5 *sj\ji}\ J> ikjJ jZ- I :JU jjli C>j :oii' :Jli 'Jh>! : Jli .i >i~J0 ji :oii' : JIS :ji> :Jli lap ji :Jji : Jli li£ ^ jiVl JI ^ail» o>JI till tji * • JI* *«—>j «So, I asked my Lord, "Who is this?" He said, "This is your brother Musa, son of 'Imran, and those who followed him among the Children of Israel." I said, "O Lord! Where is my Ummah?" Allah said, "Look to your right on the hill," and I looked and saw faces of men. Allah said, "Are you pleased," and I said, "I am pleased O Lord!" Allah said, "Look to the horizon to your left," and I saw faces ofmen. He again asked, "Are you pleased," and I said, "I am pleased, O Lord!" He said, "And with them are seventy-thousand who will enter Paradise without reckoning Ukkashah bin Mihsan from Bani Asad, one of those who participated in the battle of Badr, said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Invoke Allah to make me one of them.' The Prophet £g said, •J44 &*> «O Allah, make him one ofthem. Another man said, 'O Allah's Messenger, invoke Allah to make me one of them.' The Prophet jg said, « ifj jli v'Ukkashah beat you to it.

433 Surah 56. Al-Wdai'ah (27-40) (Part-27 Allah's Messenger jg said, ilj&li ^Ul ^ULit ^ r^ -^ ~ r*^ v>p uS iJsSil J; \yj& ^L> «Jj^ i Ji Liu cJ?5 iTherefore, may I sacrifice my father and mother for you! Try to be among the seventy (thousands), or among the crowds on the right, or the crowds that covered the side of the horizon, because I saw large crowds gathering on that side." He jg continued: «SLJl jit \f£ it yrv J\> «/ hope that you will be afourth of the people of Paradises and we said, 'AUahu Akbar.' He jg said, i jit iii ijSjfc it yrvS «/ hope tlmt you will be a third of the people ofParadise. and we said, 'AUahu Akbar.

The Prophet said, • Jal >-</>; o' yr !>! «/ hope that you will be half of the people ofParadise, and we said 'AUahu Akbar.' Then Allah's Messenger gg recited this Ayah: iA multitude of those will be from the first generation . And a multitude of those will befrom the later generations We said to each other, Who are those seventy thousand?' We then said, They are those who were bom in Islam and did not associate (anything or anyone in the worship of Allah).' When what we said reached the Prophet jg, he said, {Js-j 'Jj jyy^j Vj <.dj'y&j 'j J,AJl uThey are the people who do not get treated by cauterization themselves, do not ask for Ruqyah (get oneself treated by the recitation ofsome verses of the Qur'an) and do not draw an evil

omenfrom (birds), but put their trust (only) in their Lordy* 11 This Hadith has many chains of narration collected in the Sahihs and other collections of Hadith)21 %M V j, t \j\ '(j cJj £ '{,££ \j\$ ipiZgi j5 |«f^ ^4 bj'o: 3' H £5 8\$ g. I^t jj^ ojiilii \$ jgj ^ (j: *4. 6>>^S ^ i *£ »j8r* t& 6&U ^^ 4-^icfjl' (.jp jidj; U 441 . And those on the left? How will be those on the left?} 442. In Samum, and Hamim.} 443. And a shadowfrom Yahmiim,} 444. Neither Barid nor Karim,} i45. Verily, before that, they indulged in luxury,} 446. And were persisting in great sin.} 447. And they used to say: "When we die and become dust and bones, shall we then indeed be resurrected?"} 446. "And also ourforefathers?"} i49. Say: "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times."} 450. "All will surely be gathered togetherfor appointed meeting ofa known Day."} 451 . "Then verily, - you the erring - ones, the deniers!"} 452. "You verily, will eat of the trees ofZaqqum."} 453. "Then you will fill your bellies Herewith,"} 454. "And drink the Hamim on top of it."} 455. "And you will drink (that) like Al-Him!"} 456. That will be their entertainment on the Day of Recompense!} [11 Al-Hakim 4:577. FathAl-Bdri 10:164, 224, 11:312, 413, and Muslim 1:198, 199, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:139, and Ahmad 1:401.

435 Surah 56. Al-Waqi'ah (41-56) (Part-27) Those on the Left and Their Recompense After Allah mentioned the condition of those on the right hand, He then mentioned the condition of those on the left hand, ^ifp!40£& t iAnd those on the left? Hou> will be those on the left?} meaning, What is the condition of those on the left,' then explains His statement, by saying, i-ts- 4^ 4in Samiim,} means, a fierce hot wind, iand Hamm.} i.e., boiling water, it. iAnd a shadoiv from Y(dunum,} the shadow of smoke, according to Ibn 'Abbas/ Mujaihid, 'Ikrimah, Abu Salih, Qatadah, As- Suddi and others.121 In a similar statement, Allah said, i"Depart you to that which you used to deny! Depart you to a shadow in three columns, neither shady nor of any use against the fierce flame of the Fire." Verily, it throws sparks like fortresses, as if they were yellow camels or bundles of ropes. Woe that Day to the deniers>(77 : 29-34). Allah said in this Ayah, i\$f}t£z uj iAnd a shadowfrom Yahmum,} meaning, black smoke, i&iif % pS^ 111 At-Jabari 23:129. 121 Al-Tabari 23 :129 , 130.

^Neither Barid nor Karim,} means, it neither brings soft, cool breeze nor appears clear. Al-Hasan and Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, in or Karim "Its sight is not pleasant."* 11 Ad-Dahhak said, "Every drink that is not fresh, is not Karim (pleasant)." 21 Then, Allah the Exalted stated that they deserve this end, 4 <%> 4Verily, before that, they indulged in luxury,} meaning, in the life of the world, they were enjoying life's pleasures and satisfying their lusts, all the while ignoring what the Messengers brought to them, rfi '^f} 4And were persisting}, means, they persisted and did not intend to repent, 4in great sin.} in disbelief in Allah and claiming that the idols and rivals were gods besides Allah. It means idolatry, according to Ibn 'Abbas. This is also the meaning reported from Mujahid Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.*3 ' Allah said, bjCf. -j\ U akj <0% ili ill \)£} iAnd they used to say : "When we die and become dust and bones, shall we then indeed be resurrected? And also our forefathers?"} They said this while denying and rejecting the idea that resurrection will ever occur. Allah the Exalted said, ^ pJ*. 'Thi OjC-y^i [1 ' At-Tabari 23:131. |2) At-Tabari 23:131. At-Tabari 23:132.

437 Surah 56. Al-Waqi'ah (41-56) (Part-27) 4, Say; "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. All will surely be gathered together for appointed meeting of a known Day."} meaning, 'Say, O Muhammad, that the earlier and latter generations of the Children of Adam will be gathered for the Day of Resurrection and none of them will be left out. Allah the Exalted said: 5@ju&a fr* S & * Sr*£ ^ iThat is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, and that is a Day when all will be present. And We delay it only for a term fixed. On the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.}(l 1:103-105) He also said here, >T\loy 4AU will surely be gathered together for appointed meeting of a known Day.} because that time is precisely designated and will not come late, early, nor increase or decrease. Allah said, 4Then verily, - you the erring-ones, the deniers! You verily, will eat of the trees of Zaqqum . Then you will fill your bellies therewith.} indicating that they will be seized and made to eat from the Zaqqum tree until their stomachs become full, 4And drink the Hamim on top of it. And you will drink (that) like Al-Him!} Hamim is boiling water, while Al-Him means thirsty camels, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Sa'Id bin Jubayr and

' ^SGJp Ikrimah.111 As-Suddi «»<• 'M-Htm is a s** --7 , ~ dlsease that strikes ^j—4 camels, causing them <J:\V<G':V *#4 . r,^ ~< to feel thirst, and they T&(* ***(&#** drink until they die" -Z>q& / jjy. Therefore, he said, the ft PeoPle of Hell > will never quench their thirst from drinking / >r>5,< ;W;< i ;; j:' #""**»" ^ (fi 9 '^ -£ *>dj 1;Lii!U^p Allah, the Exalted, said ' «»* ."""" ,ta> entertainment on the Day of Recompense \$ H hiS a' We ave ,, r , ^ ^ ^ described, is their\$,his- "ha' We *ave .fZ descnbed . 1S their ^ entertainment with > :frr < . <*&& i -f theirLordon theDay of ^ their Reckoning.' Allah 0 the Exalted said in the * caseofthe believers, 4## erJ^ «£&• £^ *££)i i^J £w •\$& 4Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, shall have the Gardens of Al-Firdaws (Paradise) for their entertainment.} (18:107), i.e., hospitality and honor. & f &* '@S>j i; |gjS/£3 ^ju j££a&^ e^V>*LJ V L 4 joj J jje 0^ Cy Opj' lyii iif'o&2 V> j,Vi Tii j i57. We created you, then why do you believe not?4 458. Do you not see the semen you emit.\$ At-Tabari 23:136.

459. Is it you who create it, or are We the Creator?} 460. We have decreed death to you all, and We are not outstripped,} 461. To transfigure you and create you in (forms) that you know not.} 462. And

indeed, you have already known the first form of creation, why then do you not remember?} Proof that Resurrection will occur Allah asserts that Resurrection will occur and refutes the misguided atheists who deny it, those who said. 4When we die and become dust and bones, shall we then indeed be resurrected?} [56:47] They said this statement in denial and discounting Resurrection. Allah the Exalted said, 4We created you,} meaning, “We have created you after you were nothing. Therefore, is not that Who is able to start the creation, more able to bring it back?” Allah’s statement, 4>} & 4then why do you believe not?} “why do you not then believe in Resurrection?” Then Allah said, while bringing forth evidence that Resurrection occurs. rAjjisfc wpSjLj U fi} 4Do you not see the semen you emit. Is it you who create it, or are We the Creator?} meaning, ‘do you make the semen remain in the wombs and create life from it therein, stage after stage? Or is Allah the One Who does all this?’ Allah said, tepees& 4We have decreed death to you all,} meaning, *We made death exist between you.’ Ad-Dahhak commented, “Allah made the residents of the heavens and earth equal with regards to

death.”111 Allah said, 4j»j c£ Cj} iand We are not outstripped,} meaning, We are never unable,’ JjJ jI&} 4To transfigure you}, meaning, “to change your current shapes, on the Day of Resurrection,” 4°nd create you in that you know not.} meaning, ‘out of shapes and forms.’ Allah the Exalted said, ijj& d/fi lUlif Jftfr 4And indeed, you have already known the first form of creation, why then do you not remember?} meaning, *you know that Allah has created you after you were nothing. He created you and gave you hearing, sight and hearts. Will you not then remember and take heed that HeWho is able to create you in the beginning is more able to bring you back and resurrect you to life anew?’ Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat, L5-V. 4And He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him.£(30:27), «i£ 4> J5 oi i-iC- \$ yfi} 4Does not man remember tlmT We created him before, while he was nothing?}(19:67), yi G v^y S* bji *Hu iiiiX cl j fof} h&&\$ TXd zsM^ j; jyyr^ js &£ 4Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent. And he puts forth HI Al-Qurtubi 17:216.

442Surah 56. Al-Wdqi'ah (63-74) (Part-27) for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: “Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?” Say: "He will give life to than Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knower of every creation.">(36:77-79), and, & at f 22 ii \$ JL% 3 ci%} 4Does man think that he will be left neglected? Was he not a Nutfah of sanen emitted? Then he became an ‘Alaqah (a clot); then shaped and fashioned in due proportion . And made of him two sexes, male and female. Is not He able to give life to the dead?}{75:36-40) jJjki &L>- JUi jj5 y* jS U >\$.*& jSfct 2k %>& 463. Do i/oh not see what you sow.} 464. Is it you that make it grow, or are We the Grower?} 465. Were it Our will, We could crumble it to dry pieces, and you would be Tafakkahun .} 466. (Saying :) “We are indeed Mughramiin!”} 467. “Nay, but we are deprived!”} 468. Do you not see the water that you drink.} 469. Is it you who cause it to come down from Al-Muzn, or are We the Cause of it coming doion?} 470. If We willed, We verily could make it salty; why then do you not give thanks?} 471. Do you not see the fire which you kindle.} 472. Is it you who made the tree thereof to grow, or are We the Grower?} 473. We have made it a Reminder, and an article of use for the Muqwin.}

474. Then glorify with praises the Name of your Lord, the Most Great.} Allah’s Oneness demonstrated by causing the Plants to grow, sending down the Rain and creating the Fire that Mankind needs Allah

the Exalted said, 4Do you not see what you sow.} in reference to tilling the earth and planting seeds inside it, 4r*yQ 'fi'.} <Is it you that make it grow,} 'do you cause these seeds to grow inside the earth,' £ ft 4or are We the Grower?} Allah says, 'rather it is We Who cause the seeds to remain firmly and grow inside the earth.' Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah m said, J ^33 «Do not say, "Zara'tu (I made it grew)," but say, "Harathtu (I soioed& tilled).» Abu Hurayrah added, "Have you not heard Allah's statement, 1 -r > *. ' .1 " •>1, ,< lP4 p j-T"* U pi'j'r 4Do you not see what you sow. Is it you that make it grow, or are We the Grower?} '^ Allah the Exalted said, 4£&W >&)} 4Were it Our will, We could crumble it to dry pieces,} meaning, *We caused the seeds to grow with Our compassion and mercy and left them intact inside the earth as mercy for you. IfWe will, We would turn them diy before they ripen and 111 At-Tabari 23:139, and Al-Bazz&r 1289.

443Surah 56. Al-Waqi'ah (63-74) (Part-27 get ready to be harvested,' 4^ iatid you would be Tafakkahun .} Allah explained this statement by saying, 4 cM S. tWk&Q 4(Saying :) "We are indeed Mughramiin! Nay, but we are deprived!"} Allah says, 'if We crumble the plants into diy pieces, you would be wondering regarding what happened, sometimes saying: we are indeed Mughramun, i.e., ruined.' Mujahid and Ikrimah said that Mughramun means, being the subject of revenge . 111 Qatadah commented, "You would say, *We were punished,' sometimes, and, "We were deprived,' some other times. 'Ikrimah said that "You will be Tafakkahun' means "You will blame each other (and yourselves), '•3| or, feel sorrow, according to Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi.'4 ' They will be feeling grief for what they spent or for the sins that they have committed in the past (which cost the destruction of their plants). Al-Kisa'I said, "Tafakkaha is both the synonym and the antonym." The Arabs say Tafakkahtu when they mean that they have enjoyed something or felt grief. Allah the Exalted said next, 4y>> S j pr.^£34 &K 4Do you not see the water tluit you drink. Is it you who cause it to come downfrom Al-Muzn,} meaning clouds, according to Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others.'51 Allah said, 4Sj!p'> cfr m At-Tabari 23:141. 121 At-Tabari 23:141. At-Tabari 23:140. At-Tabari 23:140. ,S1 At-Tabari 23:143.

for are We the Causer of it to come dozen?} Allah is stating that indeed He is the One Who causes the rain to fall, icd i&L its j} ilfWe willed, We verily could make it salty;} meaning salty, sour, undrinkable and unfit for growing plants, 4why then do you not give thanks?} 'why do you not appreciate the favor Allah does for you by sending down the rain fresh, ready to consume,' Jt-j'-b 'i; 1L.J J3} d>i 4 j\ j^=. vliSV'J 4From it you drink andfrom it (grows) the vegetation on which you sendyour cattle to pasture. With itHe causes togrowforyou the crops, the olives, the date palms, the grapes, and every kind of fruit. Verily, in this is indeedan evidentproofanda manifest sign farpeoplewhogive thought.}(16:l0-l 1) Allah said, \$ 'M 4Do you not see the fire which you kindle.} 'and the fire you start with the use of trees,' 41s it you who made the tree thereof to grow, or are We the Grower?} meaning, 'rather We have made kindling fire possible.' The Arabs had two kinds of trees called Al-Markh and Al-'Afar (that they used to ignite a fire). When they would rub a green branch from each of these two trees against each other, sparkles of fire would emit from them. Allah's statement, 4We have made it a Reminder,} of the Hellfire, according to

445Surah 56. Al-Wdqi'ah (63-74) (Part-27 Mujahid and Qatadah.111 Qatadah said, "We were told that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, i jjJ U «0 people, this fire of yours that you kindle, is but one part out ofseventy parts of the fire ofHell .» They said, "O Allah's Messenger! This fire alone is sufficiently

hot.” The Messenger 5g said, >, .:s- (° Jr>. l*i £f~i ~ yZjjf [.UL] JLi n/f uws submerged in the water twice so that the Children of ‘Adam would be able to benefit from it and draw closer to ""v This narration from Qatadah which is Mursal, was recorded by Imam Ahmad in his Musnad from Abu Hurayrah, from the Prophet #i; YjJj .r^ r- j Ji Crfr-* b*. *3=r j!“ »o>-Sl 4i)l J"- l* liiJi « Verily, this fire of yours is one part out of seventy parts of the fire of Hell. It was struck twice against the sea, otherwise, Allah would not have made benefit in it for anyone .»|3’ Imam Malik also recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah’s Messenger jg said. O”” ’*5* Orfr- Cfi *j* ^ «77ie /ire f/wf tfie Children of ‘Adam kindle is one part out of seventy parts of the fire of Hell . They said, “O Allah’s Messenger! This fire alone is sufficiently hot.” He said, 111 At-Tabari 23 :144 121 At-Tabari 23:144. 131 Ahmad 2:244.

'V'-'* _j ji i^Ji® “(The fire of Hell) was made sixty-nine times hotter.s’ 1 ’ Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith from Malik and Muslim from Abu Az-Zinad . Allah’s statement, iand an article of use for the Mucfwin> Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and An-Nadr bin ‘Arabi said, “The mean- ing of Al-Muqwin is travelers . (31 This is also what Ibn Jarir chose, and he said, “From it comes the saying Aqwat Ad-Dar (the house has become empty), when its people traveled.” 141 ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that here Al-Muqwi means the hungry. Layth bin Abi Sulaym reported that Mujahid said about the Ayah, iand an article of use for the Muqwn For those who are present at their homes and travelers, for every kind of food that requires cooking by fire.” Ibn Abi Najlh also reported that Mujahid said, “For the Muqwin, means, all people who enjoy (eating food cooked by fire).” |S| Similar was mentioned from ‘Iknmah, and this explanation is more general than the previous, since those who are in their own locale and traveling, whether rich or poor, all need fire for cooking, heating and lighting purposes. It is out of Allah’s kindness that He has made the quality of kindling fire in some elements, such as stones, that people can use and take in the baggage for their journeys. When a traveler needs fire at his campsite for cooking and heating, he takes out these substances and uses them to kindle fire. He feels comfort next to the fire and he can use it for various needs that he has. Al-Muwatta’ 2 :994 Fath Al-Bdri 6 :380 , Muslim 4 :2 184 At-Tabari 23:145. At-Tabari 23:146. ,s| At-Tabari 23:145.

Allah mentions this favor specifically in the case of travelers, even though everyone benefits from the fire. Allah’s statement, 4Then glorify with praises the Name of your Lord, the Most Great.} meaning, the One by Whose ability these things opposites were created. He created the fresh tasty water, and had He willed. He would have created it salty like seawater. He also created the fire that burns, and made a benefit in it for the servants, suitable for their livelihood in this life and as a warning and a punishment for them in the Hereafter. 4 fSfJ 505 A 4^2 j £2 gZi w-jA-i yj OJ 'il i4_.*«. li '—C 475. Fala! I swear by the Mawaqi' of the stars.} 476. And verily that is indeed a great oath, if you but know.} 477. That (this) is indeed an honorable recitation.} 478. In a Book Maktmn.} 479. Which none touches but the pure ones.} 480. A revelation from the Lord of all that exists.}

448 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 481. Is it such a talk that you are Mudhinun?} 482. And you make your provision your denial!} Allah swears to the Greatness of the Qur’an The usage of La (in Fala) is not an extra character without meaning, as some of the scholars of Tafsir say. Rather it is used at the beginning of an oath when the oath is a negation. This is like when ‘A’ishah, may Allah be pleased with her said, “La by Allah! Allah’s Messenger sg did not touch any woman’s hand at all.” So in this way, the meaning is, “No! I swear by the Mawaqi' of the stars. The matter is not as you people claim - about the Qur’an -

that it is a result of magic or sorcery, rather it is an Honorable Qur'an." Ibn Jarir said, "Some of the scholars of the Arabic language said that the meaning of: 4l~\$ ^} 4Fala! I swear> is. The matter is not as you people have claimed.' Then He renews the oath again by saying, 'I swear.'"*2 4Fald! I swear by the Mawaqi' of the stars.} Mujahid said, "The setting positions of the stars in the sky," and he said that it refers to the rising and setting positions.*3 This was said by Al-Hasan, Qatadah and preferred by Ibn Jarir.*4 * Qatadah also said that it means their positions.*5 Allah said, 4And verily that is indeed a great oath, if you but know.} meaning, this is a great vow that I - Allah - am making; if you knew the greatness of this vow, you will know the (1 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :504 At-Tabari 23:147. ' At-Tabari 23:148. At-Tabari 23: 148. *S At-Tabari 23:148.

449 Surah 56. Al-Wdqi'ah (75-82) (Part-27 greatness of the subject of the vow,' iThat (this) is indeed an honorable recitation.} means, verily, this Qur'an that was revealed to Muhammad jg is a Glorious Book, ihi a Book Maknun.} meaning glorious; in a glorious, well- guarded, revered Book. Ibn Jarir narrated that Ismail bin Musa said that Sharik reported from Hakim, that is Ibn Jubayr, from Said bin Jubayr, from Ibn 'Abbas that about: 4[4] iWhich none touches but the pure ones.} he said, "The Book that is in heaven."11 ' Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas about: % ,L% 4} iWhich none touches but the pure ones.} that "the pure ones' means: "The angels. ' Similar was said by Anas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Ash-Shalha' Jabir bin Zayd, Abu Nahlk, As-Suddi, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others.'3' Ibn Jarir narrated that Ibn 'Abdul-Ala said that Ibn Thawr said that Ma'mar said from Qatadah about: 4} iWhich none touches but the pure ones.} that he said, "None can touch it, with Allah, except the pure ones. However, in this life, the impure Zoroastrian and the filthy hypocrite touch it." And he said, "In the recitation of Ibn Mas'ud it is: 4\ liL; U) (It is not touched, except by the pure ones.)'4' 111 At-Tabari 23:149. 121 At-Tabari 23:150. ' At-Tabari 23 :150, 151 , and Al-Qurtubi 17:235. 141 At-Tabari 23:152.

Abu Al-'Aliyah said: iJZ. fy iWliich none touches but the pure ones.} "It does not refer to you, because you are sinners!"! * Ibn Zayd said, "The Quraysh disbelievers claimed that the devils brought down the Qur'an. Allah the Exalted stated that only the pure ones touch the Qur'an, as He said: er 4And it is not the Shaydtin who have brought it doivn. Neither would it suit them nor they can (produce it). Verily, they have been removed far from hearing it.>(26:210-212) "21 This saying is a good saying, and does not contradict those before it. Allah said, 4 :A Cjj } 4A revelation from the Lord of all that exists.} meaning this Qur'an is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists, not as they say that it is magic, sorcery or poetry. Rather it is the truth, no doubt about it; there is none beyond it of useful truth. Allah's statement, 41s it such a talk that you are Mudhinun?} Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that Mudhinun means, "You do not believe in and deny."*31 Similar to this was said by Ad- Dahhak, Abu Hazrah and As-Suddi.*4 Mujahid said, i^} iMudhintin} means "You want to fill yourselves with and rely upon."151 At-Tabari 23:151. * At-Tabari 23:149 from Ad-Dahhak. 131 At-Tabari 23:153. At-Tabari 23:153. At-Tabari 23:153.

4 AT pJjj iAnd you wake your provision your denial/> some of them said that provision here has the meaning of gratitude, meaning: you deny without any gratitude. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he recited it as: r » > zi # ^ » ' > , , (And your show of your gratitude by denying!) Ibn Jarir narrated from Muhammad bin Bashshar, who narrated from Muhammad bin Ja'far, who narrated

from Shulsah, from Abu Bishr, from Said bin Jubayr who said that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “It has never rained upon a people except that some of them became disbelievers by saying, ‘Such and such position of a star sent rain!’” And Ibn ‘Abbas recited: (And you show of your gratitude by denying.)² This chain of narration is Sahih to Ibn ‘Abbas. In his Muwatta’, Malik reported from Salih bin Kaysan, from ‘Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah bin Tjbah bin Mas‘ud, from Zayd bin Khalid Al-Juhani who said, “The Prophet s led us in the Subh (dawn) prayer at Al-Hudaybiyah after a rainy night. On completion of the prayer, he faced the congregation and said, t * l, ' - ' - # , , JU liU “Do you know z what your Lord has said (revealed)? Those present replied, ‘Allah and His Messenger know best.’ He said, L^k* : «JU j* LiU t*j lSj y Jej* lyi ^-^* -Jl A’jS’j ils :JU y U’1) ^ Vj illJU It’s) y ji? iuiu “Allah has said, “During this morning some of my servants remained as true believers in Me and some became disbelievers. Wlwever said that the rain ivas due to the blessings and the At-Tabari 23 : 154 , 155. At-Tabari 23 : 154

mercy of Allah, had belief in Me, and he disbelieves in the stars ; and whoever said that it rained because of a particular star, had no belief in Me, but believes in that This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs, Abu Dawud and An-Nasal, all using a chain of narration in which Imam Malik¹² ' was included. Qatadah said, “Al-Hasan used to say, ‘How evil is that all that some people have earned for themselves from the Book of Allah, is denying it!’” Al-Hasan’s statement means that such people gained no benefit from the Book of Allah because they denied it, as Allah said: ils it such a talk that you Mudhinun? And you make your provision that you deny!} v pt 40& ;Vj*’ *y*T / 1,5^ . * s * i’ »' ^ . • , s s ^ ^ ** ^ 453. Then why do you not (intervene) ivhen it reaches Al- Hulqum?} }84. And you at the moment are looking,} 485. But We are nearer to him than you, but you see not,} 486. Then why do you not - ifyou are not Madmin} 487. Return the soul, ifyou are truthful?} When the Soul reaches theThroat at theTime ofDeath, it cannot be brought back; this proves Reckoning shall occur Allah the Exalted said, 4Then why do you not (intervene) when it reaches}, in reference to the soul, 111 Al-Muwatta’ 192. Fath Al-Bari 2:388, Muslim 1:83, Abu Dawud 4:227, An-Nasal

iAl-Hulqum\$, i.e., the throat, at the time of death. Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat, 4Nay, when (the soul) reaches to the collar bone, and it will be said : "Wlw can cure him (and save him from death)?" And he will conclude that it teas (the time) ofparting (death); And one leg will be joined with another leg (shrouded). The drive will be on that Day to your Lord (Allah).\$(75:26-30) Allah said here, 4 - a ! ojj^ A).» 4And you at the moment are looking, at the dying person and witnessing the stupor ofdeath that he is experiencing, 4‘P40&¥ iBut We are nearer to him than you,\$ with Our angels, 4,'oj V 4but you see not.\$ you cannot see the angels. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, Uiy Aiiij? *4*^ ‘t Qe-ilit- ’fofc- 4 p% j vi^ & ? Sr. v# 4He is the Irresistible over His servants, and He sends guardians (angels) over you, until when death approaches o)ie ofyou, Our messengers (angel of death and his assistants) take his soul, and they never neglect their duty. Then they are returned to Allah, their true Protector. Surely, for Him is the judgement and He is the swiftest in taking account.\$(6:61-62) Allah’s statement, „AV,jC..A* JVC 'p oj Vjii^ iThen why do you not - if you are not Madinin - rehirm the soul,\$

means, “Will you not return this soul, that has reached the throat, to its body as it used to be, ifyou are exempt from the reckoning and recompense?” Said bin Jubayr and Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: iThen why do you not - ifyou are not Madinm...}, “If you do not believe that you will be reckoned, recompensed, resurrected and punished, then why do you not return this soul to its body?” Mujahid said that, 4 }

4if you are not Madinin means, “if you are not certain.” ^ «X 4 ft; ^ j. l? o> Ot Jj£ .V.ojUiJI ol? Ol Vtli 4 V (4^ •*£> gh (4-* > j* '£* oj. . 488. Then, if he be of the Muqarrabin,} 489. Then Raivh, Rayhdn and a Garden of Delights.} 490. And if he be of those on the right,} 491 . Then Saldm (peace) to you from those on the right.} 492. But if he be of the denying, the erring,} 493. Then for him is an entertainment with Hamim.} 494. And entry in Hellfire.} 495. Verily, this! This is an absolute truth with certainty.} 496. So, glorify with praises the Name of your Lord, the Most Great.} The Condition of People at the Time of Their Death These are the three types of conditions that people face upon their death. Either they are among the near believers or those below their rank on the right, or those who denied the truth, were led astray from the guidance and were ignorant about Allah. Allah said, 4ot' 4Then if he}, in reference to the dying person.

r- of} 4be of the Muqarrabun} who fulfilled the obligations and the recommended acts of worship and avoided the forbidden and disliked matters and even some of the allowed, 4then for him Raxvh, Rayhan and a Carden of Delights.} Theirs will be Rawh and Rayhan; and the glad tidings of these traits will be conveyed to them by the angels at the time of death. We mentioned before the Prophet's Hadith narrated from Al-Bara' in which the angels of mercy say (to a dying, believing person), jlAjjj t rc l « «<?£ <— «0 good soul in the good body that you inhabited, come to Raxvh, Rayhan and a Lord Who is not angry 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas, “Rawh means rest, and Rayhan means place of rest.”^2 ' Mujahid said similarly that Rawh means rest.*31 Abu Hazrah said that Rawh means: “Rest from the world.” 141 Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi said that it means to rejoice. And from Mujahid: iRawh and Rayhan} means: “Paradise and delights.” Qatadah said that Rawh means mercy. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said that Rayhan means provisions. All of these explanations are correct and similar in meaning. The near believers who die will earn all of these; mercy, rest, provision, joy, happiness and good delights, iatid a Carden of Delights.} Abu Al-'Aliyah said, “None of the *** At-Tiwal no. 25. Similar was recorded by Abu Dawud and others. At-Tabari 23:159. ,31 At-Tabari 23:160. [4] At-Tabari 23:160. '*!***»*#

456 Tafslr Ibn Kalhtr near believers will depart (this life) until after he is brought a branch of the Rayhan of Paradise and his soul is captured in it.” 111 Muhammad bin Ka*b said, “Every person who dies will know upon his death if he is among the people of Paradise or the people of the Fire.” In the Sahth, it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah said, is*ji i ^ c- “The souls of the martyrs live in the bodies of green birds flying wherever they wish in the Cardens of Paradise, and then rest to their nests in chandeliers hung from the Throne of the Almighty ... Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Ata' bin As-Sa'ib said, “The first day I saw 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Layla, I saw an old man whose hair had become white on his head and beard. He was riding his donkey and following a funeral. I heard him say, ‘So-and-so narrated to me that he heard the Messenger of Allah jte say, uj -iwij ij ifj iii isS i,i ;iij -I “He who likes to meet Allah, Allah likes to meet him, and he who hates to meet Allah, Allah hates to meet him.o The people around him started weeping, and he asked them why they wept. They said, ‘All of us hate death.’ He 5#; said, day ^ ~Xhf li| .c£!j lillj _li s j* y jul 'UJ »_j»-l 'Jij lili % i: W ux j[z& C/\ «sdy ju: Jar. i iii »iij ;/ Jjyi «/f does not mean that. When one dies: iThen, if he be of the near believers, then for him are Rawh, Rayhan, and a Carden of Delights.} and zohen this good nezus is conveyed to him, he 1,1 At-Tabari 23 : 160 121 Muslim 3:1502.

457 Surah 56 . Al-Wdai'ah (88-96) (Part-27) likes to meet Allah the Exalted and Most Honored and Allah the Exalted and Most Honored likes, even more, to meet him, 4 But if he be of the denying, the erring, then for him is an entertainment ivith Hamim. And entry in Hellfire.> and when this news is conveyed to him, he hates to meet Allah and Allah hates, even more, to meet /iijh .»*' This is the narration that Imam Ahmad collected; and in the Sahih, there is a Hadith with this meaning collected from 'A'ishah . Allah's statement, 4 v .vsP vt os" oi ul)y i And if he be of those oti the right, means, if he, the dying person, is among those on the right, i'SoiS U2 22 4 Then Salam (peace) to you from those on the right} meaning, the angels will deliver the good news to them by saying, "Peace be upon you," i.e., be calm, you will be led to safety, you are among those on the right, as 'Ikrimah said, "The angels will greet him with the Salam and convey to him the news that he is among those on the right." This is a good explanation, and it conforms with Allah's statement, % \y\j£ Vi U& Jdj uldL'-i p Jif ijJli lf i'V py* Jt "ij C U 4 Verily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah." and then they stand firm, on them the angles toill descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised! We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and therein you shall have (all) for which you ask. An entertainment from the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} 111 Ahmad 4:259. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :364 , Muslim 4 :2065

(41:30-32). Allah's statement, 4 But if he be of the denying, the erring, then for him is an entertainment with Hamim (boiling water) and entry in Hellfire> meaning, if the dying person is one of those who denied the truth, who were led astray from guidance, it then for him is an entertainment,\$> meaning, as a guest *yj iwith Hamim> that dissolves his intestines and skin, 4 And entry in Hellfire. he will reside in Hellfire, which will engulf him from every direction. Allah the Exalted said, next, 4 Verily, this! This is an absolute truth with certainty meaning, this news is the truth; there is no doubt about it, nor escape from it for anyone, 4 if <%> \ £sr-*^ 4 So, glorify with praises the Name of your Lord, the Most Great. Jabir narrated that the i&jl^ 2LL- 3 sLi Messenger of Allah j|| said, "He who says, "Glory be to Allah the Magnificent and with His praise!" then a date tree will be planted for him in Paradise. » This Hadith was collected by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal; At- Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Gharib."ll] Al-Bukhari recorded in his book (Sahih) that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Ii] TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :434 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :207

459 Surah 56. Al-Waqi'ah (88-96) (Part-27) Allah jg said, C> l ^1 jb—> tjlj-Jl ^ jtdLaj ijUJUl o jbXi^0 Up-la<Jl <bl ioJl*>uj Jill *(There are) two statements that are light on the tongue, but heavy on the Balance, and most beloved to Ar-Rahmdn : "Glory be to Allah and with His praise, glory be to Allah the Magnificent." s The Group, with the exception of Abu Dawud, collected this.

Surah 57: Al-Hadid

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5744]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Hadid (Chapter - 57)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5744–5761]

The Virtues of Surat Al-Hadid Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Irbad bin Sariyah said that the Messenger of Allah used to recite Al-Musabbih[^] before he went to sleep, saying, s_iji \a J Zl jU «In them there is an Ayah that is better than a thousand AyatJ Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal collected this Hadith; At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib.’ {3} The Ayah referred to in this Hadith is - and Allah knows best - ^ r . p* s.\$[> JjV' iHe is Al-Aunval and Al-Akhir, Az-Zahir and Al-Bdtin . And He is the All-Knower ofeverything.^{57:3} Allah willing, we will again mention this subject. Upon Allah we trust and our total reliance and dependence are on Him, and sufficient He is to us as Supporter and Helper. ^0 P — In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Mercifid. Surahs, or chapters in the Qur’an that start by Tasbih (glorifying Allah) ; refer to Surahs 57 , 59 , 61 ,62 , 64 ^ Ahmad 4 : 128 . See the following note i3 Abu Dawud 5:304, Tuhfnt Al-Ahwadhi 8:238, 9:351. There is a deficiency in the narration. It may be that the most correct narration is that of Ad-Darimi no. 3424, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra no. 10551 , which is Mursal.

) CjfeA lii" ,*! i , yj -f-j'f'j 4A:ft & yy I^g*5 ^ y :| •jy^ 4 ^ y £-? / 4* yj 41 . Whatever is in the heavens and the earth glorifies Allah - and He is the Almighty, All-Wise.} 42. His is the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. It is He Who gives life and causes death; and He is Able to do all things.} 43 . He is Al-Amval and Al-Akhir, Az-Zahir and Al-Bdtin. And He is the All-Knower ofeverything.} Everything that exists glorifies Allah and mentioning some ofHis Attributes In this Ayah, Allah states that everything that exists in the heavens and earth praises and glorifies Him, including creatures and plants. Allah said in another Ayah, jyiiS V \$) !&. fiA VJ jor <jj Lily Sr} J*J {ft' <1 / -/>< ^^ U \jjlt L^W- Jb A 4The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving .4(17:44) And His saying: 4AA' Aj4 4and He is the Almighty,} meaning the One to Whom all things submit humility, 4All-Wise .4 in His creating, commanding and legislating, -jy. ^ A? iHis is the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. It is He Who gives life and causes death;} He is the absolute Owner of His creation, bringing life and death and granting what He wills to whom He wills.

t'J- 'S& iand He is Able to do all things. whatever He wills, is, and whatever He does not will, will never be. He said, < !#& %% JjVf& 4He is Al-Axoival and Al-Akhir, Az-Zahir and Al-Batin. This is the Ayah indicated in the Hadith of Irbad bin Sariyah that is better than a thousand Ayat. Abu Dawud recorded that Abu Zamll said, "I mentioned to Ibn 'Abbas that I felt something in my heart. He said, 'Doubts?' and then laughed. Next, he said, 'No one can escape this. Allah the Exalted stated, jjH Jj)J cn jllLl idl Qyl 'is iii ^ Jffy 4So if you are in doubt concerning that which We have revealed to you, then ask those ivho are reading the Book before you. Verily, the truth has come to you from your Lord. \$>(10:94)' He then said to me, *When you feel any of this in your heart, recite, ^%% j]Vf 4He is Al-Awwal and Al-Akhir, Az-Zahir and Al-Batin . And He is the All-Knower of everything.y"^^ There are about ten and some odd number of different sayings collected from the scholars of Tafsir regarding the explanation of this Ayah. Al-Bukhari said, "Yahya said, 'Az- Zahir: knowing all things, Al-Batin: knowing all things.'"121 Our Shaykh Al-Hafiz Al-Mizzi said, "Yahya is Ibn Ziyad Al- Farra', who authored a book entitled Ma'ani Al-Qur'an." There are Hadiths mentioned about this. Among them, Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg would recite this supplication while going to bed, iirf iC-ii ^ ill V 'iSyb\j jjJli i 1 111 Abu Dawud 5:335. 121 Fath Al-Bari 13 :374.

dJi) iE^ ,>43 jjSil cJi If-T iilji j-13 >£3iy tr^ ** ' « » . ' ;l 5i>i J* -r1 j "Jr- 8 fjA lip "O A//a/i , Lord of the seven heavens and Lord of the Magnificent Throne! Our Lord, and the Lord of everything, Revealer of the Taivrah, the Injil and the Furqdn, the Splitter of the grain of com and die date stone! I seek refuge with You from the evil of everything whose forehead You have control over. O Allah! You are Al-Awwal, nothing is before You; Al- Akhir, nothing is after You; Az-Zdhir, nothing is above You; and Al-Bdtin, nothing is below You. Remove the burden of debt from us and free us from poverty .» ' l Muslim recorded this Hadith via Sahl, who said, "Abu Salih used to order us to lay on our right side when we were about to sleep, and then say, VJJ ^3 '(^*J* '~'Yj 't'jj JS 'jJ- jA «ix> kliLs b JjVl c-jl '~1 ' j~ c->^j '3b^j >_r-b ""if •^sljl tlil-lj Up j-a>3 «0 Allah, Lord of the seven heavens and Lord of the Magnificent Throne! Our Lord, and the Lord of everything, Revealer of the Tawrah, the Injil and the Furqdn, the Splitter of the grain of com and the date stone! I seek refuge with You from the evil of everything whose forehead You have control over. O Allah! You are Al-Awwal, nothing is before You; Al- Akhir, nothing is after You; Az-Zdhir, nothing is above You; and Al-Bdtin, nothing is below You. Remove the burden of debt from us and free us from poverty . And he used to narrate that from Abu Hurayrah from the Prophet jg."121 Ahmad 2 :404. Muslim 4 :2084

t-fjy* j l* -A" Jr 4i_ . j Cjjyl-4' jt- i£jji _y»^ jjCu Uj C Jji _^j tj_» Uj .1^1)1 (j-; J_/j Uj £yC Uj £UfJ f-\$ 4 4^ (^Ji : jAS'f ji' ofjV'j vi^i Jj 4 o'i^ \$ j ;i^r He it is Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days and then rose (Istawa) over the Throne. He knows what goes into the earth and ivhat comes forth from it, and what descends from the heaven and ivhat ascends thereto. And He is with you wheresoever you may be. And Allah is the All-Seer of ivhat you do.} 45. His is the kingdom of the heavens and the earth. And to Allah return all the matters.} 46. He merges night into day, and merges day into night, and He has fidl knowledge of whatsoever is in the breasts.} Allah's Knowledge, Power and Kingdom are Limitless Allah the Exalted states that He created the heavens and earth, and all that is between them, in six Days and then rose over the Throne after He created them. We discussed this before in the explanation of Surat Al-A'raf so it is not necessary to repeat the meaning here. Allah's statement, 4He

knows what goes into the earth}, indicates His knowledge in the amount of seeds and drops of water that enter inside the earth's surface, and what comes forth from it} of plants, vegetation and fruits. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, *And He is with you wheresoever you may be. And Allah is the All-Seer of what you do.* meaning, He is watching over you and witnessing your deeds wherever you may be, on land or at sea, during the night or the day, at home or in open areas or deserts. All of that is the same before His knowledge and all of it is under His sight and hearing. He hears your speech and sees where you are. He knows your secrets and your public statements, *No doubt! They did fold up their breasts, that they may hide from Him. Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments, He knows what they conceal and what they reveal. Verily, He is the All-Knower of the (secrets) of the breasts.* (1:5) Muslim 1 : 162

them but He. And He knows whatever there is in the land and in the sea; not a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is "written in a Clear Record. (6:59) Allah's statement, *And what descends from the heaven}, pertains to rain, snow, hail and whatever Allah decides descends from heaven of decisions and commandments brought down by the honorable angels. Allah's statement, }and what ascends thereto.}, refers to angels and deeds. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith in which the Prophet ﷺ said, P 4 "To Him ascend the deeds of the night before the day falls and the deeds of the day before the night falls, n' 11 Allah said, 4And He is with you wheresoever you may be. And Allah is the All-Seer of what you do.} meaning, He is watching over you and witnessing your deeds wherever you may be, on land or at sea, during the night or the day, at home or in open areas or deserts. All of that is the same before His knowledge and all of it is under His sight and hearing. He hears your speech and sees where you are. He knows your secrets and your public statements, C Ur* \$ k AWi&& 4 3 oijj 'xqq }No doubt! They did fold up their breasts, that they may hide from Him. Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments, He knows what they conceal and what they reveal. Verily, He is the All-Knower of the (secrets) of the breasts.}(1:5) Muslim 1 : 162*

466 Tafstr Ibn KathTr Allah the Exalted said, *It may be that you are of those who do not know Him, whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day* (13:10) Surely, there is no deity worthy of worship, except Allah. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith in which the Messenger of Allah ﷺ answered Jibril, when he asked him about Ihsan: *#1^ pj jU i at Jj ilbk 4ul JLaJ ji "To worship Allah as if you see Him, and even though you cannot see Him, He surely sees Allah's statement. 4 • grj jb cfjVf) dlil <5^ iHis is the kingdom of the heavens and the earth . And to Allah return all the matters.} asserts that Allah is the King and Owner of this life and the Hereafter. Allah said in another Ayah, 4 xijfo IjM u 10 iAnd truly, unto Us (belong) the last (Hereafter) and the first (this world)* (92:13) Surely, Allah is praised for this attribute, just as He said in other Ayat, *4&S5 d/V» 4 sal is% 4\ ti\ v %? iAnd He is Allah, La ilaha ila Huwa, all praise is His in the first and in the last* (28:70), and, *ZgX% j Hi % jfX 4 Cj r* r 4Ci^ iAll the praise is Allah's, to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth . His is all the praise in the Hereafter, and He is the All-Wise, the All-Aware.* (34:1) Ml Fath Al-Bari 1 : 140 .

467 Surah 57. Al-Hadid (4-6) (Part-27) Allah owns everything that is in the heavens and earth, and all their inhabitants are servants to Him and humble before Him, just as He said, *// ^// > s • ; /f/ / ^ ,v 'Jj oylll* j ,y o',? p-i-iC iThcre is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And every one of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .? (19:93-95) This is why Allah said here, 4jy'i' gO\$ j)_>4 4And to Allah return all the matters.? meaning that all matters will be referred to Him on the Day of Resurrection and He will judge His creation as He wills. Indeed, He is the Most Just,*

UiiSIiSiii «ta ggacagB makes the length of night and day equal. Sometimes, He makes the season winter, then changes it to spring, then summer then autumn. All this He does by His wisdom and His due measure of everything in His creation, 4 Cj\Li» ft.',^ iand He has full knowledge of whatsoever is in the breasts .> He knows the secrets, no matter how concealed they are. U-. [fj-jiJj] . JJ -Oil; f'4 \$ p \jtfj & jf.% \ % a? J/i A ujyr* oj yy'^i s4j ji' Jjd- j Vi ^3 lij ' . JsJ.J '.if j> j j't w. lib!' at at (d>^l aLdJ* jla^ ^-4' d-* at a* ^-t ay—i V at3^1r oy it ai? 6 o* u, ifj if :& 3b ijB;£ k^ a_^V' ii[ilyjfi]'joyU ' ^CP) j) j. %1 1 ^0 jfsfr*fi ' j * j>fs% 4_jdydldC-i jks_> i^4^ii^y-jijj^jAildJ-ijid i^j 4>''jb 6 'J-yCat<3^0*S^~t ofj^L?v ^ lij\$ \$%fj0 47. Believe in Allah and His Messenger, and spend of that whereof He has made you trustees. And such of you as believe and spend, theirs will be a great reward.« 48 . And what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! While the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord; and He has indeed taken your covenant, if you are real

dM; % iuu w iii Jij IJU ju 5:1 j>; c?0~iaU Q%3 JLjaJ j 1 t O-IL li jl iC-Hili ^abundance diverts you.}

The Son of 'Adam claims, "My wealth, my ivealth." But is there anything belonging to you, except that

which you consumed, which you used, or which you wore and then it became loom or you gave as charity and sent it forward?^ Muslim also collected with the addition: aS”jL>j « 1jj 1 iJjLli i£j~? *Other than that , you zwill go away from it and leave it behind for other people Allah’s statement, ijf* ^ iyjXl iAnd such ofyou as believe and spend, theirs will be a great reward.} encourages having faith and spending in acts of obedience. Allah the Exalted said, i£;j &&% &s> *£c# iAnd what is the matter with you that you believe not in Allah! While the Messenger invites you to believe in your Lord;} meaning, “what prevents you from believing, while the Messenger is among you calling you to faith and bringing forward clear proofs and evidences that affirm the truth of what he brought you?” And we have reported the Hadlth through different routes in

the beginning of the explanation on the chapter on Faith in Sahih. Al-Bukhari, wherein one day the Messenger of Allah m said to his Companions, Ahmad 4:24. 121 Muslim 4:2273.

“Who do you consider among the believers as having the most amazing faith ? They said, “The angels.” He said, “”{•-fij ‘i U_>» «And what prevents them from believing when they are with their Lord?» They said, “Then the Prophets.” He said, uWhat prevents them from believing when the revelation comes down to them?» They said, “Then us.” He said, : * .» > > t • . . i- 0 LkJ J) WW JL*j «W7wt prevents you from believing, when I am amongst you? Actually, the believers who have the most amazing faith, are some people zwho will come after you ; they will find pages that they will believe m. We mentioned a part of this Hadlth when explaining Allah’s statement in Surat Al-Baqarah, iwho believe in the Chayb (unseen).>(2:3) Allah’s statement, L. 23 iand He has indeed taken your covenant,} is similar to another of His statements, \SjJ' fi>\ a 4And remember Allah's favor to you and His covenant with which He bound you wizen you said: "We hear and we obey."}(5:7), which refers to giving the pledge of allegiance to the Prophet Sfe. Ibn Jarir said that the covenant mentioned here, is that (il Al-Majma' 10 :65

472 TafsTr Ibn Katlur taken from mankind, when they were still in Adam’s loin. This is also the opinion of Mujahid, and Allah knows best.*11 Allah said, ilt is He WIw sends down manifestAyat to His servant clear proofs, unequivocal evidences and plain attestations, ithat He may bring you outfrom darkness into light. from the darkness of ignorance, disbelief and contradictory statements to the light of guidance, certainty and faith. iAnd verily, Allah is to you fill ofkindness. Most Merciful. by revealing the Divine Books and sending the Messengers to guide mankind, eradicating doubts and removing confusion. After Allah commanded mankind to first believe and spend, He again encouraged them to acquire faith and stated that He has removed all barriers between them and the acquisition of faith. Allah again encouraged them to spend, iAnd what is the matter with you that you spend iwt in the cause ofAllah? And to Allah belongs the heritage of the heavens and the earthy means, spend and do not fear poverty or scarcity. Surely, He in Whose cause you spent is the King and Owner of the heavens and earth and has perfect control over their every affair, including their treasuries. He is the Owner of the Throne, with all the might that it contains, and He is the One Who said, iAnd whatsoever you spend of anything, He will, replace it. And He is the best ofproviders. 34:39), and, m At-Tabari 23:172.

JC* Cj Juu 'PXJ- {whatever is with you, will be exhausted, and whatever is with Allah ivill remain .*(16:96) Therefore, those who trust in and depend on Allah will spend, and they will not fear

The Virtues of spending and fighting before the Conquest of Makkah Allah's statement, if if iNot equal among you are those who spent before the conqueriftg andfought. meaning those who did not fight and spend before the Conquest are not equal to those who spent and fought. Before Makkah was conquered, things were difficult for Muslims and only the righteous ones embraced Islam. After Makkah was conquered, Islam spread tremendously throughout the known world and people embraced the religion of Allah en masse. Similarly He said: >£ f * **)s s s i f/ f » yf i s 1+ s Ssss iSuch are higher in degree than those who spent and fought aftenoards. But to all Allah has promised the best (reward)f The majority considers the Conquest here to be the conquest of Makkah. Ash-Sha'bi and several others said that the Ayah refers to the treaty at Al-Hudaybiyyah.m There is proof for this opinion found in a Hadlth from Anas, collected by Imam Ahmad. Anas said, "Khalid bin Al-Walid and 'Abdur-Rahman bin 'Awf had a dispute. Khalid said to 'Abdur-Rahman, 'You boast about days (battles) that you participated in before us.' When the news of this statement reached the Prophet jg he said, [i] At-Tabari 23 : 175

475 Surah 57. Al-Hadid (7-11) (Part-27) though some of them vary in rank and earn a better reward than others as Allah said, ﴿وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهَوْنَ﴾ UxM & 4Nof equal are those of the believers who sit (at home), except those who are disabled, and those who strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives. Allah has preferred in grades those who strive hard and fight with their wealth and their lives above those who sit (at home). Unto each, Allah has promised good, but Allah has preferred by a great reward those who strive hard and fight, above those who sit (at home), ﴿(4:95)

There is a Hadith in the Sahih that states, *"The strong believer is better and more beloved to Allah than the weak believer; both have goodness in them"*. The Prophet ﷺ ended his statement this way to draw attention to the second type of believer, so that their own qualities are not forgotten in the midst of preferring the former type. In this way, the latter is not dismissed as being degraded in the

Hadith. Therefore, the Prophet ended his statement by praising the second type - the weak believers - after giving preference to the first type. Allah said: 4And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.} meaning, since Allah is perfectly aware of all things. He made distinctions between the rewards of the believers who spent and fought before the Conquest and those who spent and fought afterwards. Surely, Allah does this by His knowledge of the intention of the former type and their perfect sincerity to Him, all the while spending in times of hardship, poverty and dire straits. This is found in the Hadith, m Muslim 4 : 2052

•wL'l <iU jli.» «Spending one Dirham is preceded over a hundred thousand There is no doubt that the people of faith consider Abu Bakr As-Siddiq to be the person who has the best share according to the meaning of this Ayah. He was the chief of those who implemented it, among all followers of all Prophets. He spent all of his wealth seeking the Face of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. He did it voluntarily too, not to repay a debt or a favor that anyone from mankind had on him. May Allah be pleased with him. The Encouragement to make a Handsome Loan in the Cause of Allah Allah said, 4 is' l/>u ifj' 'i Jif iWho is he that will lend Allah a handsome loan :\$> 'Umar bin Al-Khattab said that this Ayah refers to spending in Allah's cause. It was also said that it pertains to spending on children. What is correct is that it is more general than that. So all those who spend in the cause of Allah with good intentions and a sincere heart, then they fall under the generality of this Ayah. This is why Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah: <2 Cj} is' J»ju Ij 4Who is he that will lend Allah handsome loan : then (Allah) zuill increase it manifold to his credit (in repaying), and in another Ayah, imamj times\$ (2:245), meaning, being handsome reward and tremendous provisions: Paradise on the Day of Resurrection. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, "When this Ayah, m An-Nasal 5 :59.

4/i Li^j ii' 4Who is he that will lend Allah handsome loan : then (Allah) will increase it manifold to his credit (in repaying) ,> was revealed, Abu Ad-Dahdah Al-Ansari said, 'O Allah's Messenger! Does Allah ask us for a loan?' The Prophet said, "Yes, O Abu Ad-Dahdah . He said, 'Give me your hand, O Allah's Messenger,' and the Prophet placed his hand in his hand. Abu Ad-Dahdah said, Verily. I have given my garden as a loan to my Lord.' He had a garden that contained six hundred date trees; his wife and children were living in that garden too. Abu Ad-Dahdah went to his wife and called her, 'Umm Ad-Dahdah!' She said, 'Here I am.' He said, "Leave the garden, because I have given it as a loan to my Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored.' She said, That is a successful trade, O Abu Ad-Dahdah!' She then transferred her goods and children. The Messenger of Allah sg said, ^lj'. JLLc- oHozo plentiful are the siveet date clusters that Abu Ad-Daliddli has in Paradise/»" In another narration, the Prophet& said, ji llij'ji- liVi* ilio i How many a date tree that has lowered dmvn its clusters, which are full of pearls and gems in Paradise for Abu Ad- Dahdah!^ i*- 1* Jljii .j.jljtji jy7 JH Ijj JJ&- ffi' vC /j 1 S4. £>? tfi cHf 111 This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim no. 2430, and At-Tabari in the

Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah 2 :245 , and there is a witness for it with

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5761–5773]

ji-35 v ,Uu 1 '? 5^^ j A' ^ *4 ijXyi ' j*~*?J*) y-~y's *(' - <^J '-'''1 j4 ' *^J (^TM5 472. On //i(' Drti/ t/oK shall see the believing men and the believing women - their light running fonoard before them and in their right hands. Clad tidings for you this Day! Cardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell

therein forever! Truly, this is the great success!¹ 3. On the Day when the hypocrites men and women will say to the believers : "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light!" It will be said: "Go back to your rear! Then seek a light!" So, a wall will be put up between them, with a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it will be torment. 414. (The hypocrites) will call the believers: "Were we not with you?" The believers will reply: "Yes! But you led yourselves into temptations, you looked forward to our destruction; and you doubted, and you were deceived by false hopes, till the command of Allah came to pass. And the deceiver deceived you in regard to Allah. 415. So, this Day no ransom shall be taken from you, nor of those who disbelieved. Your abode is the Fire. That is your protector, and worst indeed is that destination The Believers are awarded a Light on the Day of Resurrection, according to Their Good Deeds Allah the Exalted states that the believers who spend in charity will come on the Day of Resurrection with their light preceding them in the area of the Gathering, according to the level of their good deeds. As reported from 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud: 4?r.-? 4 (*->> 4their light running forward before themK he said, "They will pass over the Sirat according to their deeds. Some of them will have a light as large as a mountain, some as a date tree, some as big as a man in the standing position. The least among them has a

light as big as his index finger, it is lit at times and extinguished at other times." Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir collected this Hadith)^ Ad-Dahhak commented on the Ayah, "Everyone will be given a light on the Day of Resurrection. When they arrive at the Sirat, the light of the hypocrites will be extinguished. When the believers see this, they will be concerned that their light also will be extinguished, just as the light of the hypocrites was. This is when the believers will invoke Allah, 'O our Lord! Perfect our light for us.'" Allah's statement, and in their right hands.\$ Ad-Dahhak said: "Their Books of Records."121 As Allah said: iSo whosoever is given his record in his right hand.>(17:71) Allah said, 4Glad tidings for you this Day! Gardens under which rivers flow,} meaning, it will be said to them, "Receive glad tidings this Day, of gardens beneath which rivers flow, i'fe 4to dwell therein forever!}, you will remain therein forever," ajp't iTruly, this is the great success!} The Condition of the Hypocrites on the Day of Resurrection Allah said, Of o-f** Ct-k' iy-'. ofjij I oyf-Lji At-Tabari 23:179. At-Tabari 23:179.

iOn the Day when the hypocrites men and women will say to the believers : "Wait for us! Let us get something from your light!" Allah informs us in this Ayah of the terrible horrors, horrendous incidents and tremendous events that will take place on the Day of Resurrection in the Gathering Area. No one will be saved on that Day, except those who believed in Allah and His Messenger, obeyed Allah's commands and avoided His prohibitions. Al-'Awfi, Ad-Dahhak and others reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "When the people are gathering in darkness, Allah will send light, and when the believers see the light they will march towards it. This light will be their guide from Allah to Paradise. When the hypocrites see the believers following the light, they will follow them. However, Allah will extinguish the light for the hypocrites and they will say (to the believers), A'fjj o? Si iWait for us! Let us get something from your light .)» The believers will reply by saying, '4Go back to your rear!\$ to the dark area you were in, and look for a light there!'" Allah said, 4So, a wall will be put up between them, zwith a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it zwill be torment. Al-Hasan and Qatadah said that the wall mentioned here is located between Paradise and Hellfire. 121 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that the wall mentioned in this Ayah is the wall that Allah described in His statement, r~t 1 '^ iAnd

between them will be a (barrier) screen. [7:46] 111 At-Tabari 23:182. 121 At-Tabari 23 : 182, and Ibn Abi Shaybah 13:175. 131 At-Tabari 23:183.

481 Surah 57. Al-Hadid (12-15) (Part-27 Similar was reported from Mujahid and others, 111 and it is correct. Allah said, inside it will be mercy, } meaning, Paradise and all that is in it, and outside it will be torment. ^ meaning, the Hellfire, according to Qatadah, Ibn Zayd and others. 121 Allah said, ip j2 £ £/£ } i(The hypocrites) will call the believers: "Were we not with you?" } meaning, the hypocrites will call out to the believers saying, "Were we not with you in the life of the world, attending Friday prayers and congregational prayers? Did we not stand with you on Mount 'Arafah (during Hajj), participate in battle by your side and perform all types of acts of worship with you?" iThe believers will reply: "Yes!..." } The believers will answer the hypocrites by saying, "Yes, you were with us, } But you led yourselves into temptations, you looked forward to our destruction; and you doubted (in faith) and you were deceived by false hopes, } " Qatadah said, iyou looked forward to destruction}, "Of the truth and its people." At-Tabari 23:182. At-Tabari 23:184.

482 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr iand you doubted,} that Resurrection occurs after death, 4and you were deceived by false hopes,} meaning: you said that you will be forgiven your sins; or, they say it means: this life deceived you; *&} 4till the command of Allah came to pass.} meaning: you remained on this path until death came to you, iAnd the deceiver deceived you in regard to Allah.} 'the deceiver' being Shaytan .' 1| Qatadah said, "They were deceived by Ash-Shaytan. By Allah! They remained deceived until Allah cast them into Hellfire."*21 The meaning here is that the believers will answer the hypocrites by saying, "You were with us in bodies which were heartless and devoid of intentions. You were cast in doubt and suspicion. You were showing off for people and remembered Allah, little." Mujahid commented, "The hypocrites were with the believers in this life, marrying from among each other, yet betraying them even when they were associating with them. They were dead. They will both be given a light on the Day of Resurrection, but the light of the hypocrites will be extinguished when they reach the wall; this is when the two camps separate and part!"*31 Allah's statement, }Your abode is the Fire.} means, the Fire is your final destination and to it will be your return for residence, iThat is your protector,} meaning, it is the worthy shelter for you Al-Tabari 23:185. At-Jabari 23:185. At-Tabari 23:184.

483 Surah 57. Al-Hadid (16-17) (Part-27) rather than any other residence, because of your disbelief and doubt, and how evil is the Fire for Final Des- tination. jC tij jjll X»V> jl£i ot .li&J' -»r- »?* S»y (*r; rrs> ^—u ^ & y ipa jXj 111 JU If^yl JU) itpbfcZ j&-& 416. Has not the time yet come for the believers that their hearts should be humble for the re- membrance of Allah? And that which has been revealed of the truth, lest they become as those who received the Scripture before, and the term was prolonged for them and so their hearts were hardened? And many of them were rebellious> 417. Know that Allah gives life to the earth after its death! Indeed We have made clear the Ayat to you, if you but understand Encouraging Khushu' and the Prohibition of imitating the People of the Scriptures Allah asks, 'Has not the time come for the believers to feel humility in their hearts by the remembrance of Allah and hearing subtle advice and the recitation of the Qur'an, so that they may comprehend the Qur'an, abide by it, and hear and obey?' Muslim recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ad said, "Only four ^ °r' ^1 A'-' >>> ;»:r J >-! N 1)O&j*) 'tSj Si [y~tl» jy^jiyp3 * >i ^ V id • > *J uj. rtJvJLaJ 0^pp

years separated our acceptance of Islam and the revelation of this Ayah, in which Allah subtly admonished us, 4Has not the tune yet come for the believers that their hearts should be humble for the remembrance of Allah?}” This is the narration Muslim collected, just before the end of his book.’ An-Nasal also collected this Hadith in the Tafsir of this AyahP Allah’s statement, iiV* ‘fff j_j ijiy <Lesf they become as those who received the Scripture before, and the term was prolonged for them and so their hearts were hardened?} Allah is prohibiting the believers from imitating those who were given the Scriptures before them, the Jews and Christians. As time passed, they changed the Book of Allah that they had, and sold it for a small, miserable price. They also abandoned Allah’s Book behind their back and were impressed and consumed by various opinions and false creeds. They imitated the way others behaved with the religion of Allah, making their rabbis and priests into gods beside Allah. Consequently, their hearts became hard and they would not accept advice; their hearts did not feel humbled by Allah’s promises or threats, iZ,M °&> iAnd many of them were rebellious.} meaning, in action; therefore, their hearts are corrupt and their actions are invalid, just as Allah the Exalted said, £J,bp f . t_nn.fi—j — pt py" jT/ iX \Jgi .***£ 4So, because of their breach of their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts grow hard. They changed the words from their (right) places and have abandoned a good part of the Muslim 4:2319. An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& 6 :48 1

Message that zoos sent to them .\$(5: 13) meaning, their hearts became corrupt and they hardened, and they acquired the behavior of changing Allah’s Speech from their appropriate places and meanings. They abandoned acts of worship that they were commanded to perform and committed what they were prohibited to do. This is why Allah forbade the believers from imitating them in any way, be it basic or detailed matters. Allah the Exalted said, 4Know that Allah gives life to the earth after its death! Indeed VVe have made clear the Ayat to you, if you but understand.} This Ayah indicates that He brings subtleness to hearts after they have become hard, guides the confused after they were led astray, and relieves hardships after they have intensified. And just as Allah brings life back to the dead and dry earth by sending the needed abundant rain, He also guides the hardened hearts with the proofs and evidences of the Qur’an. The light (of faith) would have access to the hearts once again, after they were closed and, as a consequence, no guidance was able to reach them. All praise is due to Him Who guides whomever He wills after they were misguided, Who misguides those who were led aright before. Surely, it is He Who does what He wills and He is the All-Wise, the Most Just in all that He does, the Most Subtle, the Most Aware, the Most High, the Proud. 3 S&k iSL 3 '£% ciiZS, &X& ie A IP* Ufa ife;uX 418. Verily, those who give Sadaqat, men and women, and lend Allah handsome loan, it shall be increased manifold (to their credit), and theirs shall be an honorable good reward. 419. And those who believe’ in Allah and His Messengers, they are the Siddiqi in (true believers) and the martyrs with their Lord. They shall have their reward and their light. But those who disbelieve and deny Our Ayat - they shall be the dwellers of the blazing Fire.}

486 Tafsir Ibirt Kathir Reward for the Charitable, the True Believers and the Martyrs; and the Destination of the Disbelievers Allah the Exalted describes the reward that He will award to those who spend from their wealth, whether male or female, on the needy, the poor and the meek, iand lend Allah handsome loan,)> meaning, they give in charity with a good heart seeking the pleasure of Allah. They do not seek worldly rewards or appreciation from those to whom they give in charity. Allah’s statement, 4it shall be increased manifold, indicating that He will multiply the good deeds from tenfold, up to

seven hundredfold and even more than that. and theirs shall be an honorable good reward. theirs will be a generous, handsome reward, a good dwelling to return to and an honorable final destination. Allah's statement, 4And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers - they are the Siddiqun This completes His description of those who have faith in Him and in His Messengers, by describing them as Siddiqun, true believers. Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas about 4And those who believe in Allah and His Messengers - they are the SiddTqiin} that its meaning does not continue to the next Ayah, iand the martyrs (are) with their Lord. They shall have their reward and their light. |i] At-Tabari 23:191.

Abu Ad-Duha (stopped after he) recited. jti 4they are the Siddtqiin then initiated recitation: iand the martyrs (are) with their Lord. Masruq, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan and others said similarly. Al-A'mash narrated from Abu Ad-Duha from Masruq from 'Abdullah bin Mas"ad commented on Allah's statement, 4they are the Siddiqtin, and the martyrs ivith their Lord. "They are of three categories," meaning there are those who spend in charity, the Siddiqun and the martyrs. Allah the Exalted said, jji-'i'j '-it 4And whoso obey Allah and the Messenger, then they ivilt be in the company of those on whom Allah has bestowed His grace, of the Prophets, the Siddiqin, the martyrs, and the righteous (4:69) Therefore, Allah made a distinction between the Siddiqin and the martyrs, indicating that they are of two distinct categories, so there is no doubt that Siddiq is a better status than the martyr. Imam Malik bin Anas recorded in his Muwatta' that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ja ^ 'jAZs "The people of Paradise will look at the dwellers of the lofty mansions as one looks at a brilliant starfar away in the east or in the west on the horizon, because of their superiority over one another .» At-Jabari 23:191.

On that the people said, "O Allah's Messenger! Are these lofty mansions for the Prophets whom none else can reach?" The Prophet replied, 1 hnI JI^j toXj ^ "No! By Him in Whose Hand is my soul! these are for men who believe in Allah and believe in the Messengers, » Al-Bukhari and Muslim also collected this HadithS 1 ^ Allah's statement, iand the martyrs with their Lord.} means that they will be in the gardens of Paradise, as recorded in the Sahih: <jjlj jU ioJli Jt ^!B M L>S :)& liU : Jlii iLj Jiiliil ill; JI ji : Jlii lift Jji Ilia U5 iji&i ili Jjl2i ulJt jIJJI JI CtVy 11 v 14J1 "The souls of the martyrs live in the bodies ofgreen birds, who fly wherever they wish in Paradise and then return to their nests in chandeliers. Once your Lord cast a glance at them and said, 'Do you want anything?" They said, "We wish that You return us to the life of the world, so that we may fight in Your cause and be killed as we were killed the first time." Allah said, "I have decreed that they shall not be returned to it again .»|21 Allah's statement, }They shall have their reward and their light.}, means that Allah will grant them a generous reward and a tremendous light that will precede before them. In this, the believers vary regarding the level of reward they receive, according to their good actions in the life ofthis world. Imam Ahmad recorded that Umar bin Al-Khattab said that he heard the Messenger of Allah say, 111 Fath Al-Bari 6 :368 , Muslim 4 :2177 Muslim 3:1502.

Illji ijji) 2)1 ijlXAfi Xi' ofy* 4JUJ «ld&. dl & ^jjl tThere are four ranks of martyrs. The first is a man who believes and who is true in faith, who meets the enemy (in battle), fulfills his duty to Allah and is killed. This is the type that the people will look up to (his level in Paradise), like this. The Prophet jg raised his head until his cap fell off his head, and the same happened to "Umar. The Prophet jg continued. Vj* (*4" Vfk 40-^ jjiil lr!j* A&'j8 uju it^ ijujij j ijiil ji; j iiii .jJ> ai j A 'Jj8 <J*~ ^ >ti)l UI^il

4— “The second is a believer who meets the enemy and is struck by a stray arrow which causes him to die. This believer is in the second grade. The third is a believer who has combined good deeds with evil deeds; he meets the enemy and is truthful to his duty to Allah until he is killed. This is the third category. And the fourth is a believer who has committed sins excessively, so he meets the enemy and is truthful to his duty to Allah, and is killed. This is the fourth category ,#**• ‘Ali bin Al-Madlani also reported this Hadith and said, “This Egyptian chain is Salih useful.”*21 At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Gharib. ”*31 Allah’s statement, kjA !)*J£=y \jJ& & 4But those who disbelieve and deny Our kyat - they shall be the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} 111 Ahmad 1 :23 121 'Hal Al-Hadith 1 :349 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :274 . The statement of ‘Ali bin Al-Madlani is

regarding which chain is preferred . Most of the scholars consider

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5773–5792]

this Hadith to be weak.

4Beautified for men is the love of things they covet; women, children, much of gold and silver (wealth), branded beautiful horses, cattle and well-tilled land. This is the pleasure of the present world's life; but Allah has the excellent return with Him.^(3:14) Allah, the Exalted also sets a parable for this life, declaring that its joys are fading and its delights are perishable, saying that life is, 4^& iLike a rain (Ghayth),\$ which is the rain that comes down to mankind, after they had felt despair. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, 4iritis £ j_o ^ tijjl y*j\$ iAnd He it is Who sends down the Ghaijth (rain) after they have despaired.\$(42:28) Allah’s statement, 4Z ithereof the growth is pleasing to the tiller;\$ meaning that farmers admire the vegetation that grows in the aftermath of rain. And just as farmers admire vegetation, the disbelievers admire this life; they are the most eager to acquire the traits of life, and life is most dear to them, dP.1/ 'A •» > ' Jtv f 1 Aj/t gjy 4afterwards it dries up and you see it turning yellow; then it becomes straw. meaning, that vegetation soon turns yellow in color, after being fresh and green. After that, the green fades away and becomes scattered pieces of dust. This is the parable of this worldly life, it starts young, then matures and then turns old and feeble. This is also the parable of mankind in this life; they are young and strong in the beginning. In this stage of life, they look youthful and handsome. Slowly, they begin growing older, their mannerism changes and their strength weakens. They

then grow old and feeble; moving becomes difficult for them, while doing easy things becomes beyond their ability. Allah the Exalted said, iAllah is He Who created you in (a state of) weakness, then gave you strength after weabiess, then after strength gave (you) weakness and grey hair. He creates what He wills. And He is the All-Knowing, the All-Poiverfid . \$>(30 :54) This parable indicates the near demise of this life and the imminent end of it, while in contrast, the Hereafter is surely coming. Those who hear this parable should, therefore, be aware of the significance of the Hereafter and feel eagerness in the goodness that it contains, jjt i£l^ £•J O'yiojs 4lll (V »yu*I JjJU*uW iBut in the Hereafter (there is) a severe torment, and (there is) forgiveness from Allah and (His) pleasure. And the life of this world is only a deceiving enjoyment meaning, surely, the Hereafter that will certainly come contains two things either severe punishment or forgiveness from Allah and His good pleasure. Allah the Exalted said, yz ufr (£jt *And the life of this world is only a deceiving enjoyment meaning, this life is only a form

of enjoyment that deceives those who incline to it. Surely, those who recline to this life will admire it and feel that it is dear to them, so much so, that they might think that this is the only life, no life or dwelling after it. Yet, in reality, this life is insignificant as compared to the Hereafter. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, «Jui jL j&i) ^ 'fSoj- 1 f,-) SijjD «Paradise is nearer to any of you than the strap on his shoe, and so is the (Hell) Fire . »* 11 Ahmad 1 : 387.

493 Sarah 57. Al-Hadid (20-21) (Part-77) Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith through the narration of Ath-Thawnj ' This Hadith indicates the close proximity of both good and evil in relation to mankind. If this is the case, then this is the reason Allah the Exalted encouraged mankind to rush to perform acts of righteousness and obedience and to avoid the prohibitions. By doing so, their sins and errors will be forgiven and they will acquire rewards and an exalted status. Allah the Exalted said, iRace with one another in hastening towards forgiveness from your Lord, and Paradise the width whereof is as the width of the heaven and the earth,) Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, ^ .M, CjjA JojSi\j O'jU-IJf dl 4 And march forth in the way (to) forgiveness from your Lord, and for Paradise as wide as the heavens and the earth, prepared for those who have Taqia.) {3: 133} Allah said here, i' ^ S* 4) Cr* J®' kill'j .ALjj jilt i prepared for those who believe in Allah and His Messengers. That is the grace of Allah which He bestows on whom He is pleased with. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty.) meaning, This, that Allah has qualified them for, is all a part of His favor, bounty and compassion.” We mentioned a Hadith collected in the Sahih in which the poor emigrants said to the Messenger jg, “O Allah’s Messenger! The wealthy people will get higher grades and permanent enjoyment.” He asked, «? i)G *Why is that?» They said, “They pray like us and fast as we do. However, they give in charity, whereas we cannot do that, and that free servants, whereas we cannot afford it.” The Prophet jg said,

495 Surah 57. Al-Hadid (22-24) (Part-27) inscribed in the Book of Decrees before We bring it into existence. Verily, that is easy for Allah .) 423. In order that you may not grieve at the things over that you fail to get, nor rejoice over that which has been given to you. And Allah likes not prideful boasters 4.24. Those who are misers and enjoin miserliness upon people. And whosoever turns away, then Allah is Rich, Worthy of all praise. Everything that affects Mankind, is duly measured and destined Allah reminds of His measuring and deciding the destiny of all things before He created the creation, Zl "4) cjtiv' 4 ot v£*^ 4 No calamity occurs on the earth nor in yourselves) meaning, ‘there is nothing that touches you or happens in existence,’ 4 but it is inscribed in the Book of Decrees before We bring it into existence.) meaning, ‘before We created the creation and started life.’ Qatadah commented on this Ayah, 4 ^ i) 4 No calamity occurs on the earth) refers to famine, while, 'jj) 4 or nor in yourselves) refers to suffering and diseases.” He also said, “We were told that every person who suffers a prick of a thorn, a twisted ankle, or a bleeding vein, has it occur on account of his sins. What Allah forgives is even more.”^ This great, honorable Ayah provides clear evidence to the misguidance of the cursed Qadariyyah sect, who deny Allah’s Preordainment and His knowledge of everything before it occurs. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr bin A1-‘As m At-Tabari 23 :196

496 Tafslr Ibn Kathir said, “I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, jS/ 1_« oljo .il l jliu l)I jt\$\\jL«jl 4iil jii «A//lli ordained the measures (of everything) fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth .»” * ' Muslim collected this Hadith in his Sahih with the addition: •jUJI Jla jLSj" oAnd His

Throne was over the water. At-Tirmidhi also collected it and said, “Hasan Sahfh.”*2 * Allah’s statement, 4I’ Jc Jij’i iVerily, that is easy for Allah.} means that He knows all things before they occur, and He records them exactly as they will occur when they occur, and this is easy for Him. Verily, Allah knows what happened, what will happen and what did not happen, and what shape and form it will take if it were to happen. Ordering Patience and Gratitude Allah said, 1; cl. £& ipt- iln order that you may not grieve at the things over that you fail to get, nor rejoice over that which has been given to you.} meaning, We informed you of Our encompassing knowledge, recording all things before they occur and creating all things in due measure known to Us, so that you may know that what has met you would never have missed you and what has missed you would never have met you. Therefore, do not grieve for what you have missed of fortune, because had it been destined for you, you would have achieved it.’ (It is also recited:) 111 Ahmad 2:169. Muslim 4 :2044 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :370

497Surah 57. Al-Hadid (22-24) (Part-271 (nor rejoice over that which came to you) meaning, come to you. According to the recitation, it means iwhich has been given to you> Both meanings are related. Allah says here, ‘do not boast before people about what Allah has favored you with, because it is not you who earned it by your efforts. Rather, all this came your way because Allah destined them for you and provided them for you as provisions. Therefore, do not use what Allah has granted you as a reason to boast and become arrogant with others.’ Allah’s statement, iAnd Allah likes not prideful boasters meaning, who acts arrogantly with other people. Ikrimah commented by saying, “Everyone of us feels happiness and grief. However, make your joy with gratitude and endure your griefwith patience.” Censuring the Stinginess Allah the Exalted then said, it atevM 4Those who are misers and enjoin miserliness upon people.> meaning those who commit evil and encourage people to commit it, 4And whosoever turns away,} from abiding by Allah’s commandments and obeying Him, 4XJS Sil itthen Allah is Rich, Worthy of all praise.)» As Musa, peace upon him, said. be 4If you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich, Owner of all praise.^ (14:8) 111 At-Tabari 23 :198

A25. Indeed We have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs, and revealed with them the Scripture and the Mizdn that mankind may keep up justice. And We brought forth iron wherein is mighty power, as well as many benefitsfar mankind, that Allah may test who it is that will help Him (His religion) and His Messengers in the unseen. Verily, Allah is Powerful Almighty.) The Prophets were given Miracles and Sent with truthand Justice Allah the Exalted said next, Llfal Jcij£ ilindeed We have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs in reference to the miracles, the unequivocal evidences and the plain proofs, iatid revealed with them the Scripture) which contains the true text, iand the Mizan), that is, justice, according to Mujahid, Qatadahand others. This Ayah refers to the truth that is attested to by the sound, straight minds that oppose misguided opinionsand ideas, just as Allah said in other Ayat, y fal, ffa (fa faf]) ACan they (Muslims) who rely on a clear prooffrom their Lord, and whom a witness from Him follows it (be equal with the disbelievers).£ (11:17), JXi Jfi fa cfaii) m At-Tabari 23 :200.

499Siirah 57. Al-Hadid (25) (Part-27) 4Allah's Fitra (religion) with which He has created mankind.} (30:30), and, \fXij 4And the heaven : He has raised it high, and He has set up the Mizan.}(55:7) This is why Allah said here, 4that mankind may keep up justice}, truth and fairness that is found in the obedience of the Messengers, in all that they conveyed from their Lord, and following all they commanded. Surely, what the Prophets brought forth is the truth, beyond which there is no truth, just as

Allah said. 4iZj iLg& 4And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice.}[6: 115), His Word is true in what it conveys, and just in all its orders and prohibitions. This is why the believers say, when they take up their rooms in Paradise and assume their high grades and lined thrones, c; oit s3j ft 3% u;^ 4AU praise is due to Allah, Who has guided us to this, and never could we have found guidance, were it not that Allah had guided us! Indeed, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth.}(7A3) The Benefits of Iron Allah said, 4f^ <jrV *-» 4And We brought forth iron wherein is mighty power,} meaning, We made iron a deterrent for those who refuse the truth and oppose it after the proof has been established against them.' Allah's Messenger remained in Makkah for thirteen years. During that time, the revelation continued being sent to him,

containing arguments against the idolators and explaining Tawhld with detail and proofs. When the evidence was established against those who defied the Messenger Allah decreed the Hijrah. Then He ordered the believers to fight the disbelievers using swords, using them to strike the necks and foreheads of those who opposed, rejected and denied the Qur'an. Imam Ahmad and Abu Dawud recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Umar said that the Messenger of Allah sgl said, Jjj As* V i&j Jii juo Ji. ulDi . r*n . Oh^ Sill JJ-j i "/ was sent with the sword just before the Hour so that Allah be worshipped alone without partners. My provision was placed under the shadow of my spear, and those who defy my order were disgraced and humiliated, and he who imitates a people is one of them . »* !1 This is why Allah the Exalted said, ixxi *J>} i wherein is mighty power,} in reference to weapons, such as swords, spears, daggers, arrows, shields, and so forth, i^as well as many benefits for mankind,} meaning, in their livelihood, such as using it to make coins, hammers, axes, saws, chisels, shovels and various tools that people use for tilling the land, sowing, cooking, making dough and manufacturing other objects necessary for their livelihood. Allah's statement, & 111 i that Allah may test who it is that will help Him (His religion) and His Messengers in the unseen.} meaning, whose intention by carrying weapons is the defense of Allah (His religion) and His Messenger, f@V.' 4& i\ (ii Ahmad 2 :50 , Abu Dawud 4 :314

on mma5Tn jj)? ,. pl*Pj -*jAii/t ^Aj^ljb-ybJuy^July ji)-C't5j3<<Ji^oS>r^->iV •»-- >i >* < 's '^ \\"-*-tn' £"* ii-"T- —'•' f—=L')_j oj~J'U-£—yj(^UJu*:>rj o—??i ' ' 11j>-i/'oib_4-^ . L4-"j. Ls^il^j^iysUlil jvyily^ ' * bi>b3W*Acjjjs^lfcJcj (&k\$,> ^ O'f/ > . f > .-" <?> L^*J «OAljpOy^Jcj l)y ^_As. (l4b li^v. r^' J—^[' '-liu'.J Ul' ^dt ^Jr 4 easy £ Liy-jilLt obijj <?yj iil iijdj VI J>4& <g£ v^ py I l^ulis (3*" ^*yu ^3 y iVerily, Allah is Powerful, Almighty meaning, surely, Allah is Powerful, Almighty, and He gives victory to those who give victory and aid to Him. However, Allah does not need mankind's help, but He ordered Jihad to test people with each other. £Ky £j> CL3&& £&Sij »j~)^ t-ij* 4 #» D £4* fr? ?.(- =“ f \$26. And indeed, We sent Nuh and Ibrahim, and placed in their offspring prophethood and Scripture. And among them there are some who are guided; but many of them are rebellious.\$ 427. Then, We sent after them Our Messengers, and We sent 'Isa the son of Maryam, and gave him the Injil. And We ordained in the hearts of those who followed him, compassion and mercy. But the monasticism which they invented for themselves, We did not prescribe for them, but (they sought it) only to please Allah therewith, but that they did not observe it with the right observance. So, We gave those among them who believed, their (due) reward; but many of them are rebellious.}

Many of the Nations of the Prophets were Rebellious Allah the Exalted states that since He sent Nuh, peace be upon him, all the Prophets and Messengers He sent after that were from his offspring. All the

revealed Divine Books and all the Messengers that received revelation after Ibrahim, Allah's Kham, peace be upon him, were from Ibrahim's offspring. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah: and placed in their offspring prophethood and Scripture.} (29:27) The last among the Prophets of the Children of Israel was Isa, son of Mary, who prophesied the good news of the coming of Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon them both. Allah the Exalted said, iThen, We sent after them Our Messengers, and We sent 'Isa the son of Maryam, and gave him the Injil.} referring to the Injil that Allah revealed to him, 4tjd\ 4 iAnd We ordained in the hearts of those whofolloiued him,} i.e., the disciples, icompassion} and tenderness, iand mercy.} toward the creatures. Allah's statement, kXIjj} iBut the monasticism which they inventedfor themselves,} refers to the monasticism that the Christian nation invented, &} iWe did not prescribefor them} 'We - Allah - did not ordain it for them, but they chose it on their own.'

There are two opinions about the meaning of, ionly to please Allah therewith,} The first is that they wanted to please Allah by inventing monasticism. Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said this. The second meaning is: "We did not ordain them to practice that but, rather, We ordained them only to seek what pleases Allah." Allah's statement. ibut that they did not observe it with the right observance.} meaning, they did not abide by what they ordered themselves to do. This Ayah criticizes them in two ways: first, they invented in things in their religion, things which Allah did not legislate for them. The second is that they did not fulfill the requirements ofwhat they themselves invented and which they claimed was a means of drawing near to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. Ibn Jarir and Abu 'Abdur-Rahman An-Nasal - and this is his wording - recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "There were kings after 'Isa who changed the Tawrah and the InjH when there were still believers who recited Tawrah and the Injfl. Their kings were told, *We were never confronted by more severe criticism and abuse than of these people.' - they recite the Ayah, iAnd whosoever does not judge by what Allah has revealed, such are the disbelievers.}(5-A4), as well as, they accuse us of short comings in our actions, while still they recite. Therefore, summon them and let them recite these Ayat our way and believe in them our way.' The king summoned them and gathered them and threatened them with death if they did not revert from reciting the original Tawrah and Injll to using the corrupted version only. They said, Why do you want us to do that, let us be.' Some of them said, *Build a narrow elevated tower for us and let us ascend 4 111 At-Tabari 23:203.

it, and then give us the means to elevate food and drink to us. This way, you will save yourselves from hearing us.' Another group among them said, 'Let us go about in the land and eat and drink like beasts do, and if you find us in your own land, then kill us.' Another group among them said, 'Build homes (monasteries) for us in the deserts and secluded areas, wherewe can dig wells and plant vegetables. Then, we will not refute you and will not even pass by you.' These groups said this, even though they all had supporters among their tribes. It is about this that Allah the Exalted and Most Honored sent down this Ayah, o*- i'-vJ 1?) > £ \jkJic-xJ 4But the monasticism which they invented for themselves. We did not prescribe for them, but (they sought it) only to please Allah therewith, but that they did not observe it with the right observance '",11 Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas bin Malik said that the Prophet said, zEvery Prophet has Rahbdniyyah (monasticism); Jihad in the cause of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, is the Rahbaniyyah of this Umrnah . Al-Hafiz Abu Ya'la collected this Hadlth and narration, the Prophet jg said, •jil JfcjiJ ;juL tckjj in this "Every Umrnah has Rahbaniyyah; Jihad in the cause ofAllah is the Rahbaniyyah of this Utnmah. »*2 Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri

said that a man came to him and asked him for advice, and Abu Said said that he asked the same of Allah's Messenger Abu Said said, "So, I advise you to adhere by the Taqwa of Allah, because it is the chief of all matters. Fulfill the obligation of Jihad, because it is the Rahbdniyyah of Islam. Take care of At-Tabari 23 :203, An-Nasal 8 :231 Ahmad 3:266. Abu Yala no. 4204. See the following note

remembering Allah and reciting the Qur'an, because it is your closeness (or status) in the heavens and your good fame on earth." Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadith)^ Q^ .^j j.\$£ .4 I d-fti jXv O? J-iiil' JJ ili'j '.Lii d* S -U jiSIT j\j AU1 d-S J» 42S. O you who believe! Have Taqioa of Allah, and believe in His Messenger, He will give you a double portion of His mercy, and He will give you a light by which you shall walk (straight). And He will forgive you. And Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Mercifid 429. So that the People of the Scriptures may know that they have no power whatsoever over the grace of Allah, and that (His) grace is in His Hand to bestow it on whomsoever He wills. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty.> The Believers of the People of the Scriptures will earn Double their Rewards Earlier we mentioned a Hadith that An-Nasal collected from Ibn 'Abbas that this Ayah is about the People of the Scriptures who believe in Islam, and that they will earn double their reward if they do so. There is an Ayah in Surat Al-Qasas to support this meaning. 121 Also, there is a Hadith from Ash- Sha'bi from Abu Burdah from his father from Abu Musa Al- Ash'ari that the Messenger of Allah \$\$\$ said, 1 di ^ T ^' Iy. J*-J -Sij* jj5) iii tffj^J P •Three will get their reward twice. A believer from the People of the Scriphires who has been a true believer in his Prophet 111 Ahmad 3:82. These narrations are weak, Al-Albani graded the narration of Abu Said Hasan in support of the meaning. See of the above Hadiths in As-Sahihah no . 555 121 See SuratAl-Qasas 28 :52-54

and then believes in me, will get a double reward. A slave who fulfills Allah's rights and obligations as well as the duties of his master, will get a double reward. A person who has a slave-girl and he educates her properly and teaches her good manners properly (without violence) and then manumits and marries her, will get a double reward.» This Hadlth is recorded in the Two Sahihs. [I] Ad Dahhak, Utbah bin Abi Hakim and others agreed with Ibn 'Abbas in this, and Ibn Jarir preferred it. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, 64j pfJ Jvc. iiiii 40 you who believe! If you have Tacpva of Allah, He will grant you a criterion, and will expiate for you your sins, and forgive you; and Allah is Owner of the great bounty. \$(8:29) Said bin 'Abdul-'Aziz said, TJmar bin Al-Khattab asked a Jewish rabbi. What is the maximum a reward would be increased for you?' He replied, 'A Kifl (portion) which is about three hundred and fifty good merits.' So Umar said, *Praise be to Allah who gave us two Kifls.' Then Said mentioned Allah's saying: iHe will give you a double portion of His mercy, Said said, "And the two Kifls on Friday are similar to that." This was recorded by Ibn Jarir.13 This view has support from the Hadith that Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Abdullah bin Umar that the Messenger of Allah said, oiji i\ 5 bi j FathAl-B&ri 1 :229, Muslim 1 :134. At-Tabari 23 :208,210. ' At-Tabari 23:210.

—ij'ji' Jjh jJa-oJl S'iLi ^ : Jli |*i : IjJli} ijidJ &LiS]|CM ip* jjjJI JU& vf :Jtf : L_jJli ?!£i j*p& ji :Jli ACS^ nJLIi^ jjJl l_fLat 'y> Iw^i «77ie parable of you and the Jews and Christians is that of a person who employed some laborers and asked them, "Who will work for me from the Dawn prayer until midday for one Qirat (a special weight of gold) each?" So, the Jews worked. The person asked, "Who will do the work for me from the Zuhr prayer to the time of the 'Asr prayer for one Qirat each?" So, the Christians worked. Then the person asked, "Who will do the work for me from 'Asr prayer until sunset

for two Qirat each?" You are those who did this work. The Jews and the Christians got angry and said, "We did more work, but got less wages." Allah said, "Have I been unjust to you with your reward?" They said, "No." So, Allah said, "Then it is My grace which I bestow on whomever I will."« [I] Al-Bukhari collected this HadithJ2 Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Musa said that the Prophet jgg said, J 0 N :)& J0\ J! 'JP 'f PP J! Zx, ijuit V JUi '3k &J- Uj 40 tX'fo ^jJl hjA : Jlii jfr0-* 4j»^1*p Ijk irr Otf lil iJLi 4>Sll ^Jt pjy, Zx t/j-i : Jlii .Jj 0 vLUf ^jJl iu'3 4j>U l£U£ U jXX>\ d ji zZ,\i . I tj.^-1 t iy£ j 1 ^5, UJU Zju 4^w»-0l 4^0U d t it- W4J jV <U<L tjJUl IJL* ljL5 li jJlij 401-i* 4 LI4IK 111 Ahmad 2:6, 111. 121 Path Al-Bari 4 :52 1 and 6 :571

"The parable of the Muslims, Jews and Christians is that of a man who employed laborers to work for him from morning until night for a known wage. So, they worked until midday and said, 'We are not in need of the wages that you promised and our work was in vain.' So, the man said, 'Do not quit now, complete the rest of the work and yours will be the full wage I have fixed for it.' However, they refused and quit, and he had to hire another batch of workers. He said (to the second batch), 'Complete the work for the rest of the day and I will give you the same wage I promised the first batch.' So, they worked until the time of the 'Asr prayer and said, 'Whatever we have done is in vain and we forfeit the wages you promised us.' He said to them, 'Complete your day's work, for only a small part of the day remains.' However, they refused, and he employed another batch to work for the rest of the day, and they worked until sunset and received the wages of the two former batches. This is an example of them (i.e., the Jews and Christians) and of those who accepted this light (i.e., Islam). » Al-Bukhari was alone in recording it. Allah the Exalted said; oi \$2& frifr iSo that the People of the Scriptures may know that they have no power whatsoever over the grace of Allah,} meaning, so that they become sure that they cannot prevent what Allah gives, or give what Allah prevents, ji ii'j f X iff} iand that (His) grace is (entirely) in His Hand to bestow it on whomsoever He wills. And Allah is the Owner of great bounty.}

Surah 58: Al-Mujadila

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 9

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5793]

Opening The Tafstr of SuratAl-Mujadilah (Chapter - 58)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5793]

sS» In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ^ ii'j j Jj» Si' ff- <©^ 41 . Indeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you concerning her husband, and complains to Allah. And Allah hears the argument between you both. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer

Reason for revealing this Surah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5793–5825]

Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “All praise be to Allah, Who hears all voices. “The woman who disputed” came to the Prophet 5® and argued with him while I was in another part of the room, unable to hear what she said. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored revealed this Ayah, 4 Jy Si' 4Indeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you concerning her husband>”(1! till the end of this Ayah. Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith without a chain of narration in the Book of Tawhid in his Sahib. 12' An-Nasal, Ibn Majah, Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir also collected this Hadith.l3] In the narration that Ibn Abi Hatim collected, ‘A’ishah said, “Blessed is He, Whose hearing has encompassed all things. I heard what Khawlah bint Thalabah said while some of it I ' Ahmad 6:46. 121 Fath Al-Bari 13 :384 ' An-Nasal 6 :168, Ibn Majah 1 :67, and At-Tabari 23 :225.

Jr Oil gmsMm 'W, could not hear. She < > tr>T # "f* ' £}Uj I jwu dill <Ul'j ^jjac-y US jtJjJ* ^£J Cj\L- fUJsJi 0^jX£JS^ot <itjjju- -Vb^J ^U/tSS*^Uujili-Jtc^LS was complaining to Allah's Messenger &g about her husband. She said, 'O Allah's Messenger! He spent my wealth, exhausted my youth and my womb bore abundantly for him. When I be- came old, unable to bear children, he pronounced the Ziha.^ on me! O Allah! I complain to you.' Soon after, Jibrll brought down this Ayah, tj OliXjt (jii jji -lit ji^ iln indeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you con- cerning her husband, She added, “Her husband was Aws bin As-Samit.”*21 (4»j j-v'Aj Jf vj oj Jt (&*, *\ m T-? " > ' At' ££+ »>< t*A X * >' tilt "*" * ' K \ "x (rr;H & y* x-l^j Lai> ot !^=c-« jyyJ < V** 1" S x |f" 4 £">< | 1 # . "" *"? \xl t't' > >' oy^M Uj a»\j -4. o>>ii*y >4^ o' J-4 Oj 4-Jj jyZ* y^i U OjJyu (4j£-i J CH cJ j5 £u ^r1 fW* i & *jp£% bii- ^A ijtijH^ ^2. Those among you who make their wives unlawful to them by Zihar they

cannot be their mothers. None can be their Az-Zihar refers to one saying to his wife, “you are unlawful to me for cohabitation just like my mother.” Aj-Tabari 23 :226

511 Surah 58. Al-Muiddilah (2-4) (Part-28 mothers except those who gave them birth. And verily, they litter an ill word and a lie. And verily, Allah is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving. £ 43 . And those who make unlawful to them (their wives) by Zihdr and wish to free themselves from what they uttered, (the penalty) in that case is the freeing of a slave before they touch each other. That is an admonition to you. And Allah is All- Aware of what you do. 44. And he who finds not, must fast two successive months before they both touch each other. And he who is unable to do so, should feed sixty of the poor. That is in order that you may have perfect faith in Allah and His Messenger. These are the limits set by Allah. And for disbelievers, there is a painful torment. Az-Zihdr and the Atonement for It Imam Ahmad recorded that Khuwaylah bint Tha'labah said, “By Allah! Allah sent down the beginning of Surat Al-Mujadilah in connection with me and ‘Aws bin As-Samit. He was my husband and had grown old and difficult. One day, he came to me and I argued with him about something and he said, out of anger, ‘You are like my mother’s back to me.’ He went out and sat with some of his people. Then he came back and wanted to have sexual intercourse with me. I said, “No, by the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Khuwaylah! You will not have your way with me after you said what you said, until Allah and His Messenger issue judgement about our case.’ He wanted to have his way regardless of my choice and I pushed him away from me; he was an old man.’ I next went to one of my neighbors and borrowed a garment from her and went to the Messenger of Allah I told him what happened and kept complaining to him of the ill treatment I received from ‘Aws. He said, ««» 2it Jeu Sjj gj, Sli. 'J, \ «0 Khuwaylah! Your cousin is an old man, so have Taqwd of Allah regarding himj By Allah! Before I departed, parts of the Qur’an were revealed about me. Allah’s Messenger ig felt the hardship upon

512 TafsTr Ibtt Kathir receiving the revelation as he usually did and then became relieved. He said to me, •1*1^5 eJLj 4jul Jyl ii k aJl>y>- “O Khuwaylah! Allah has revealed something about you and your spouse .« He recited to me, 4Indeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you concerning her husband, and complains to Allah. And Allah hears the argument between you both. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.}, until, iAnd for disbelievers, there is a painful torment.} He jg then said to me, iij “Command him to free a slave.* I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! He does not have any to free.’ He said, •Let him fast for two consecutive months .» I said, *By Allah! He is an old man and cannot fast.’ He said, fu o* —i or-? p “Let him feed sixty poor people a Wasq111 of dates. I said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! By Allah, he does not have any of that.’ He jg said, j* o L>1» 8 # ' ' ' •We will help him with a basketl2! of dates. I said, ‘And I, O Allah’s Messenger! I will help him with another.’ He said, *** One Wasq refers to a measurement of a camel-load or the equivalent of 60 S&‘or approximately 165 liters. ^ Which was about fifteen Sa'.

s * - (<££ Aj J JLi® «Yow /flre done a righteously good thing. So go and give away the dates on his behalf and take care of your cousin . I did that.” 1 11 Abu Dawud also collected this Hadvth in the Book of Divorce in his Sunan,'2 ' according to which her name is Khawlah bint Thalabah. She is also known as Khawlah bint Malik bin Thalabah, and Khuwaylah. All these are close to each other, and Allah knows best. This is what is correct about the reason behind revealing this Surah. Therefore, Allah’s statement, ui f&l J-M} iThose among you who make their wives unlawful to them by Zihar refers to

Zihar, which is derived from Az-Zahr, meaning, the back. During the time of Jdhiliyyah, when one wanted to declare Zihar towards his wife, he would say, "To me, you are like the back of my mother." That was one way they issued divorce during that time. Allah allowed this Ummah to pay expiation for this statement and did not render it as a divorce, contrary to the case during the time of Jdhiliyyah. Allah said, 'o' 4they cannot be their mothers. None can be their mothers except those who gave them birth.} meaning, when the husband says to his wife that she is like his mother, or the back of his mother etc., she does not become his mother. Rather his mother is she who gave birth to him. This is why Allah said, j;a> Si^ O&J£0 4And verily , they utter an ill word and a lie.} meaning, false and sinful speech, Ahmad 6 :410. Abu Dawud 2 :662 , 664

iAnd verily, Allah is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving> meaning, "what you used to do during the time of Jahiliyyah, and what accidentally slips out of your mouth, unintentionally. Allah's statement, iAnd those who make unlawful to them (their wives) by Zihar and wish to free themselves from what they uttered, Ash-Shafil said, "It means to keep her for a while after the Zihar, without divorcing her, even though his is able to do so." Ahmad bin Hanbal said, "To return to having sexual relations with her or to merely intend to do so, but only after he pays the expiation mentioned in the Ayah for his statement." It has been quoted from Malik that it is the intention to have sexual relations or to keep her or actually having sexual intercourse. Said bin Jubayr said that this Ayah, ijifuyi iand wish tofree themselvesfrom what they uttered meaning, if they want to return to having sexual intercourse which was forbidden between them. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that it is to utilize her sexual organ, and he did not see any harm in doing what is less than that before paying the expiation. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas: ibefore they touch each other .i "The 'touching' refers here to sexual intercourse."111 Similar was said by 'Ata', Az-Zuhri, Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan. Az-Zuhri added, "He is not to kiss or touch her until he pays the expiation." The Sunan compilers recorded from 'Ikrimah, from Ibn 'Abbas that a man said, "O Allah's Messenger! 1 pronounced Zihar on my wife, but then had sexual intercourse with her before I paid the expia- tion." The Messenger jfi, said, m At-Tabari 23 :231

515Sarah 58. Al-Muiadilalt (2-4) (Part-28) "May Allah grant you His mercy, what made you do that?" He said, "I saw the adornment she was wearing shining in the moon's light." The Prophet jgj said, "J>-j "Then do not touch her until you do what Allah the Exalted and Most Honored has ordered you to do." At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Gharib Sahih." Abu Dawud and An- Nasal also recorded it.' Allah said, Am'*' > "Tk i(the penalty) in that case is thefreeing ofa slave} indicating the necessity of freeing a slave before they touch each other. This Ayah mentions any slave, not only believing servants as in the case ofthe expiation for (unintentional) killing, 4That is an admonition to you.} meaning, a warning to threaten you in this case. }And Allah is All-Aware ofwhat you do.} meaning, He is All-Knower in what brings you benefit. Allah's statement, if* <j; i£rt~' fC#* 2 ^} }And he who finds not must fast two successive months before they both touch each other. And he who is unable to do so, shouldfeed sixty of the poor.} is explained by the Hadiths that prescribe these punishments in this order, just as in the Hadith collected in the Two Sahihs about the man who had sexual intercourse with his wife during the day, in Ramadan.12' Allah said, I 1 ' Abu Dawud 2:666, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:380, An-Nasal 6:167, and Ibn Majah 1 :666 121 Fath Al-Bari 4 :193 , Muslim 2 :78 1

i/i [>Uj4 iThat is in order that you may have perfect faith in Allah and His Messenger.} meaning, “We legislated this punishment so that you acquire this trait,’ 4\$ yii- &j} iThese are the limits set by Allah.} meaning, the things that He has forbidden, so do not transgress them, iiLi 4Andfar disbelievers, there is a painful torment.} meaning, those who do not believe and do not abide by the rulings of Islamic legislation should never think they will be saved from the torment. Rather theirs will be a painful torment in this life and the Hereafter. ‘r’4’- fc--’.* Ji c-f iW ’Ajtji ii’ oj& l\} z ^ t yjj iit Ji? ‘fy c 4 c;^ 4 c£ 3 3 1 p\ &% Vj %\ % 4-i *. V; > •ij ili o; *£ \$i&kW7. \U c. 45 . Verily, those who oppose Allah and His Messenger will be disgraced as those before them were disgraced. And We have sent down clear Ayat. And far the disbelievers is a disgraceful torment.} 46. On the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together and inform them ofwhat they did. Allah has kept account of it, while they have forgotten it. And Allah is Witness over all things.} 47. Have you not seen that Allah knows whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth? There is no Najwd of three but He is their fourth - nor offive but He is their sixth - nor of less than that or more but He is with them wheresoever they may be. And afterwards on the Day of Resurrection He will inform them of what they did. Verily,

Allah is the All-Knower ofeverything.} Explaining the Punishment of the Enemies of the Religion Allah states that those who defy Him and His Messenger jg and contradict His commandments, iwill be disgraced as those before them were disgraced meaning, they will be humiliated, cursed and disgraced, just as what happened to their like were before them. iAtid We have sent down clear Ayat.} meaning, none contradicts or opposes them, except a disbeliever, rebellious, sinner, iAnd for the disbelievers is a disgraceful torment meaning, as just recompense for their arrogant refusal to follow, obey and submit to the religion ofAllah. Allah the Exalted said, iiiii }j\$ iOn the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together referring to the Day of Resurrection when He will gather the early and the latter generations in one area, iand inform them ofwhat they did.} He will tell them all that they did in detail, whether good or evil, iAllah has kept account of it, while they haveforgotten it.} meaning, Allah recorded and kept all these actions, even though they have forgotten what they did, fir if& 4And Allah is Witness over all things.} meaning, nothing escapes

His knowledge, and no matter is hidden from Him or escapes His complete observation. Allah’s Knowledge encompasses Creation Then Allah the Exalted informs of His knowledge encompassing all creation, observing it, hearing their speech and seeing them, wherever they may be and in whatever condition they may be in, iHave you not seen that Allah knows whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth? There is no Najwa of three}, i.e., secret consultation of three, 3 % ityc ibut He is their fourth - nor offive but He is their sixth - nor of less than that or more but He is with them wheresoever they may be.} meaning, He is watching them, perfectly hearing their speech, whether uttered in public or secret. His angels record all that they say, even though He has better knowledge of it and hears them perfectly, as Allah said; -- . »>< at \$} iKnow they not that Allah knows their secret ideas, and their Najwa, and that Allah is the All-Knower of the unseen.} (9:78), fP ^Or do they think that We hear not their secrets and their private Najwa? And Our messengers are by them to record.} (43:80) For this reason, several mentioned that there is a consensus among the scholars that this “with” refers to Allah’s knowledge. There is no doubt that this meaning is true, especially if we add to it the certainty that His hearing encompasses all things, as well as His sight. He, the Exalted and MostHonored, is neverlacking in knowing all their affairs,

519 Surah 58. Al-Mujadilah (8-10) (Part-28) > " #tr '<4^<jU*i«i'o\ (»r- ^ 1 l CSyf-o^ Jytillj 4jd£jjoVJj^, aj^C4<SjJyjiili4j Lr-ti C|^ _A-^J^, _pLil^_JL5d^j»- p» 1«j -»4~'i 4^f tor S»* 5[<Anrf afterwards on the Day of Resurrection He will inform than of ivhat they did. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} Imam Ahmad commented, “Allah began the Ayah (58:7) by mentioning His knowledge and ended it by mentioning His knowledge.” d£l? ^ £ <\$ JI J> ' >•' [>> ' >>' -1 ojpy^j ^] jr M. f •)_yff v+f"j ** i&£•. ^ L»j 'jj Cji VjJ |^_lil y Sjyuj ill Jr*»- ,4^- dj*’ bj Owwj Vi d.'JwiJ' Jlij l^JLjj ^ . i , <3^ o-J' id jOU ^*0 k^J-4* OiJ»v V) |d>3^ ,_rib «#(&\$ i>-«i «• j^JJit 48. Have you not seat those who were forbidden to hold secret counsels, and afterwards returned to that which they had been forbidden , and conspired together for sin and wrongdoing and disobedience to the Messenger. And when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not, and say within themselves: “Why should Allah punish us not for what we say?” Hell will be sufficient for them; they will enter therein. And worst indeed is that destination!} 49. O you who believe! When you hold secret counsel, do it not

— Tafstr Ibn Kathir for sin and wrongdoing, and disobedience to the Messenger, but do it for Al-Birr and Taqwa; and have Tacjwd of Allah unto Whom you shall be gathered.} ilO. Secret counsels are only from Shaytan, in order that he may cause grief to the believers. But he cannot harm them in the least, except as Allah permits. And in Allah let the believers put their trust.} The Evil of the Jews Ibn Abi Najlh reported from Mujahid, yf. Q jjjj- y i£ jfi j[j p\} iHave you not seen those who were forbidden to hold secret counsels, and afterwards returned to that which they had been forbidden,} He said, “The Jews.” ' Similar was said by Muqatil bin Hayyan, who added, “The Prophet jg had a peace treaty with the Jews. When one of the Prophet’s Companions would pass by a gathering of Jews, they would speak among themselves in secret, prompting the believer to think that they were plotting to kill or harm him. When the believer saw this, he feared for his safety and changed the route he was taking. The Prophet jg advised them to abandon their evil secret talks, but they did not listen and kept on holding the Najwa. Allah the Exalted sent down this Ayah in their case, &Q ± sif ji iHave you not seen those who were forbidden to hold secret counsels, and afterwards returned to that which they had been forbidden}. Allah’s statement, Hk ojpiyj} iand conspired together for sin and wrongdoing and disobedience to the Messenger.} (I1 At-Jabari 23:236. * * Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8 :80 . This is a Mursal narration . See the section about narrations in the beginning of the book.

521 Surah 58. Al-Mujddilah (8-10) (Part-28) means, they used to talk to each other, ifor sin} which involves themselves, }and wrongdoing^ which effects others. They speak about disobedience and defying of the Messenger with persistence and recommending each other to follow their way, *4 ') 42- jjy.t fy} when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not,} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “Some Jews came to the Prophet sg and greeted him by saying, ‘As-Sam ‘Alayka O Abul-Qasim.’ So I said to them, ‘wa ‘Alaykum As-Sam (the same death be upon you).’ The Prophet jg said, v i>\ l\ tiisu i;» “O ‘A’ishah, Allah does not like rudeness and foul speech .» I said, ‘Didn’t you hear them say, ‘As-Sam Alayka?’ He jfe said, «Didn't you hear me answering them back by saying, ‘Wa ‘Alaykum (And the same upon you)?’» Allah the Exalted then sent down this Ayah, a. •) £> ijj*. jjy.C fyj} iAnd when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not,}”™ The narration collected in the Sahih. states that ‘A’ishah said, “And be upon you the death, disgrace and curse.” The Messenger of Allah said to her, *£-> 1*4! 'jj liJ -01 aAllah accepts our supplication against them, but not theirs l 1 * See below. At-Jabari 23:236, 237.

523 Surah 58. Al-Mujadilah (8-10) (Part-28) 'Had he been a Prophet, Allah would have punished us for what we said. Allah knows what we conceal. Therefore, if Muhammad were a Prophet, Allah would have sent His punishment on us sooner, in this life.' Allah the Exalted replied, 'Hell will be sufficient for them; it should be sufficient for them in the Hereafter, they will enter therein. And worst indeed is that destination!' Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amr said that the Jews used to say, "Sam Alayka" to Allah's Messenger - They would say then within themselves, "Why does Allah not punish us for what we say?" This Ayah was later revealed,) £ 4£- AjX. i 4 And when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not, and say within themselves: "Why should Allah punish us not for what we say?" Hell will be sufficient for them; they will enter therein. And worst indeed is that destination!^ Its chain of narration is Hasan, but they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not collect it. Manners of the Najwa, (Secret Counsel) Allah the Exalted teaches His believing servants to avoid the ways of the disbelievers and hypocrites, ^ 4 *>•» £>.fj' ^r:^^ 40 you who believe! When you hold secret counsel, do it not for sin and wrongdoing, and disobedience to the Messenger meaning, do not hold evil secret counsels like the ignorant disbelieving People of the Scriptures and their allies among the hypocrites, who imitate their ways, m Ahmad 2:170.

40) .ell cijji ibnt do it for Al-Birr and Taqwa; and have Taqwa of Allah unto Whom you shall be gathered .) and He will then inform you of all your deeds and statements; He has counted and recorded them and will justly hold you accountable for them. Allah the Exalted said, ji' Jfij jji' oil. ULi- iAn-Najwa are only from the Shaytan, in order that he may cause grief to the believers. But he cannot harm them in the least, except as Allah permits. And in Allah let the believers put their trust.) Allah states that secret talks, where the believers feel anxious, are only from Shaytan, in order that he may cause grief to the believers.) meaning, that those who hold such counsels do so because of the lures of the devil, in order that he may cause grief to the believers.) The devil seeks to bother the believers, even though his plots will not harm the believers, except if Allah wills it. Those who are the subject of evil Najwa, should seek refuge in Allah and put his trust in Him, for none of it will harm them, Allah willing. The Sunnah also forbids the Najwa so that no Muslim is bothered by it. Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, , p, * \ , >u illJS 1 ~ A :>>•*! *If you were three, then two of you should not hold a secret counsel in the presence of the third person, because that would

525 Surah 58. Al-Mujadilah (11) (Part-28) cause him to be worried .t This Hadith is collected in the Two Sahihhs using a chain of narration that contained Al-A'mashJ2 'Abdur-Razzaq narrated that 'Abdullah bin Tjmar said that Allah's Messenger jg said, iui4 qq 4J&'b/i j£i 4 'J-s iii« 1f you were three, then two of you should not hold a secret counsel in the presence of the third person, except with his permission, because that would cause him to be worried.^ Muslim collected this Hadith.^ j, q \ftlju p Jj 'Si ipi* cyji 5# q % p jJj^ pi: fir pq 4\$^ 422. O i/oh who believe! When you are told to make room in the assemblies, make room. Allah will give you room. And when you are told to rise up, then rise up. Allah will exalt in degree those of you who believe, and those who have been granted knowledge. And Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.} Manners for Assemblies Allah teaches His servants good manners and orders them to be kind to each other when they are sitting together, q P Ji ill ip: SJ <&} 40 you who believe! When you are told to make room in the assemblies,} 4fp iiligP ipit^ intake room. Allah will give you room.} Indeed, the reward or recompense depends on the type of

action. In a Hadith, the Prophet ﷺ said, *q q <J <ui Ahmad 1 :425, 431. Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :58 , Muslim 4:1718. 'Abdur-Razzaq 11 :26. (41 Muslim 4:1717.*

527 Surah 58. Al-Mu'idilah 111) (Part-28) then sit in it. Rather spread out and make room and Allah will make room for you' Imam Ahmad also recorded this Hadith with the wording: "A man should not leave his place for another man , but rather spread out and make room, and Allah will make room for you".¹² It has been reported that Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others said that: *fS3& 4W/ ien yoM* are told to make room in the assemblies, make room. Allah will give you room means to war assemblies, and that, *Si 'jlf} i* And when you are told to rise up, then rise up.} means, "Get up to fight."¹³ Qatadah said *Si i* And when you are told to rise up, then rise up.} means, "When you are called to any type of good, then respond."¹⁴ ' The Virtues of Knowledge and People of Knowledge Allah's statement. *iSf- <jj£" <I>5 oi yj 'j\$ ijijl S&j ii ^i} i* Allah will exalt in degrees those of you who believe, and those who have been granted knowledge. And Allah is Well- Acquainted with what you do.} means, do not think that if one of you makes room for his brother, or rises up when he is commanded to do so, that this Ahmad 2:523. 121 Ahmad 2:338. ' At-Tabari 23:244, Al-Qurtubi 17:299, and Ad-Durr Al-Manthur At-Tabari 23:245.

528 Tafsir Ibn Kathir will diminish his right or honor. Rather, this will increase his virtue and status with Allah, and Allah the Exalted will never make his good deed be lost. To the contrary. He will reward him for it in this life and the Hereafter. Surely, he who humbles himself by and before the command of his Lord, then Allah will elevate his status and make him known by his good behavior, the statement of Allah the Exalted, *jjUu IL illfj iyjl Jlj' ipl» ill i* Allah will exalt in degree those of you who believe, and those who have been granted knowledge. And Allah is Well- Acquainted with what you do.} meaning, surely, Allah is Aware of those who deserve this reward and those who are not worthy of it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu At-Tufayl 'Amir bin Wathilah said that Nafi' bin 'Abdul-Harith met TJmar bin Al- Khattab in the area of 'Ufan. TJmar appointed Abu At-Tufayl to be the governor of Makkah. TJmar asked him, "Whom did you appoint as your deputy for the valley people (that is, Makkah)." 'Amir said, "I appointed Ibn Abza, one of our freed slaves, as my deputy." TJmar said, "You made a freed slave their governor in your absence?" He said, "O Leader of the faithful! He has memorized Allah's Book and has knowledge of regulations of inheritance, along with being a proficient judge." TJmar said, "Surely, your Prophet ﷺ has said, *dj <LI jlj t* Verily, Allah elevates some people and degrades others, on account of this *Boo/c.u*"¹ 11 Muslim collected this Hadith. 'Q Jr-^ 'H !£*' ijLii j iji yiu> jZ jr, lyjju J j jfrf- «J>1> iif 412. O you who believe! When you (want to) consult the Messenger in private, spend something in charity before your private consultation. That will be better and purer for you. But Ahmad 1 :35. ^ Muslim 1 :559.

529 Siirah 58. Al-Mu'idilah (12-13) (Part-28) if you find not (the means for it), then verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 413. Are you afraid of spending in charity before your private consultation (with him)? If then you do it not, and Allah has forgiven you, then perform Saldh and give Zakah and obey Allah and His Messenger. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.} The Order to give Charity before One speaks to the Prophet ﷺ in private Allah commanded His believing servants, when any of them wanted to speak with Allah's Messenger ﷺ in secret, to give away charity beforehand so that his charity cleanses and purifies him and makes him worthy of having a private counsel with the Prophet

jg. This is why Allah the Exalted said, 4That will be better and purer for you.} then He said, 4But if you find not.} meaning, if he is unable to do so due to poverty, &am 4then verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} He only commanded those who are financially able to give this type of charity. Allah the Exalted said, 4Are you afraid of spending in charity before your private consultation?} meaning, are you afraid that the order to give charity before speaking privately to the Prophet sg remains in effect forever? ^ a \jj& \fVj I SSS vS J# 4If then you do it not, and Allah has forgiven you, then perform Saldh and give Zakah and obey Allah and His Messenger. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.}

Therefore, Allah abrogated the obligation of giving this charity. It was said that none has implemented this command before except its abrogation, ‘Ali bin Abi Talib. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas: ay jy-Ujy ispend something in charity before your private consultation .} “The Muslims kept asking Allah’s Messenger jg questions until it became difficult on him. Allah wanted to lighten the burden from His Prophet sfe, upon him be peace. So when He said this, many Muslims were afraid to pay this charity and stopped asking. Afterwards, Allah sent down this Ayah, •jlujl jy-iti iit CJij ylij j 3\$ yiis £Z uj. lyjju J iifij}\ \j*j iAre you afraid of spending in charity before your private consultation? If then you do it not, and Allah has forgiven you, then perform Salah and give Zakah} Thus Allah made things easy and lenient for them.” ‘Ikrimah and Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on Allah’s statement: t uy ispetid something in charity before your private consultation.} “This was abrogated by the next Ayah: iAre you afraid of spending in clmrity before your private consultation.. ^.”*2 Said bin Abi ‘ArUbah reported from Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan, “People kept questioning Allah’s Messenger sg until they made things difficult for him. Allah provided a way to stop their behavior by this Ayah. One of them would need to speak to Allah’s Prophet jg about a real matter, but could not do so until he gave in charity. This became hard on people and *** At-Jabari 23:249. See the section about narrations in the beginning of the book At-Tabari 23:250.

Allah sent down relief from this requirement afterwards, jju- jU iBut if you find not, then verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful}.’*** Ma‘mar reported from Qatadah that the Ayah, Cjy ^ 4 '4 &•. iWhen you (want to) consult the Messenger in private, spend something in charity before your private consultation .} was abrogated after being in effect for only one hour of a day.’2 ‘ ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Mujahid said that ‘Ali said, “No one except me implemented this Ayah, until it was abrogated,” and he was reported to have said that it remained in effect for merely an hour.’3’ jUj je CiJ&j % pi j %\$\$\$& c A* 23 t&gjL ££ jif Oi A'-A pr* uj" J -** o & Oyl^z tT /J jjiCj fJJ Ifi p OSOISSS «ti iju5 ^t&^3t>4A<r~2C' J^li4I1 I j-ai4i*~|il(ajjjtfl vt 0y£C&J,S 'r'J^dX^Jjil 4»T [1 > At-Tabari 23:248. 121 At-Tabari 23:249. ,3 ‘ ‘Abdur-Razzfiq 3:280.

532 Tafstr Ibn Kathir > • SrO* && ?P < *^» oL V< 414. Have you not seen those who take as friends a people upon whom is the wrath of Allah? They are neither of you nor of them , and they swear to a lie while they know .} 415. Allah has prepared for them a severe torment. Evil indeed is that which they used to do.} 416. They have made their oaths a screen. Thus they hinder (others) from the path of Allah, so they shall have a humiliating torment.} 417. Their children and their xoealth will avail them nothing against Allah. They will be the dwellers of the Fire to dwell therein forever.} 418. On the Day when Allah loill resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you. And they think that they have something. Verily, they are liars!} 419. The Shaytan has overpowered them. So he has

made then¹ forget the remembrance of Allah. They are the party of Shaytan. Verily, it is the party of Shaytan that will be the losers!} Chastising the Hypocrites Allah chastises the hypocrites for secretly aiding and supporting the disbelievers even though, in reality, they were neither with the disbelievers nor with the Muslims. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, 4: %4\$& cX di% 3i H4 Z *+* * \ 'i sf 4(They are) swaying between this and that, belonging neither to these nor to those; and he whom Allah sends astray, you will not find for him a way>(4:143) Allah said here, !j>j crif jl j \$} 4Have you not seen those who take as friends a people upon whom is the wrath of Allah?} referring to the Jews with whom the hypocrites were allies in secret. Allah said,

}They are neither of you nor of them,} meaning, that these hypocrites are neither with the believers, nor with their allies the Jews, jc Sy£j} }and they swear to a lie while they know.} meaning, the hypocrites lie when they vow, knowing that they are lying, which is called the vow of Al-Ghamus. We seek refuge with Allah from their ways. When the hypocrites met the believers they said that they believed and when they went to the Messenger jg, they swore to him by Allah that they were believers. They knew that they were lying in their vow, and they knew that they did not declare their true creed. This is why Allah witnessed here that they lie in their vows and know that they are lying, even though their statement (about the Prophet being Allah's Prophet) is true in essence. Allah the Exalted said, ^ ^ , O^Lfc.0 \ytf U pd 111 J^i^ 4Allah has prepared for them a severe torment. Evil indeed is that which they used to do.} meaning, Allah has prepared a painful torment for the hypocrites on account of their evil deeds, their aid and support of the disbelievers and their deceit and betrayal of the believers. The statement of Allah the Exalted, if 'jju*& b'jJi} iThey have made their oaths a screen. Thus they hinder (others)from the path of Allah,} meaning, the hypocrites pretended to be believers and concealed disbelief under the shield of their false oaths. Many were unaware of their true stance and were thus deceived by their oaths. Because of this, some people were hindered from the Path of Allah &\$} }so they shall have a humiliating torment.} meaning, as recompense for belittling the significance of swearing by the

534 Tafsir Ibrt Kathir Mighty Name of Allah, while lying and concealing betrayal. Allah the Exalted said, U oS %\$\$\$ iTheir children and their wealth will avail them nothing against Allah.} meaning, none of their possessions can avert the affliction when it is sent their way, iThey will be the dwellers of the Fire to dwell therein forever.} Allah the Exalted said, ii' ft} iOn the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together;} referring to the Day of Resurrection when He will gather them all together and leave none of them out, 4then they will swear to Him as they swear to you. And they think that they have something.} meaning, they will swear to Allah the Exalted and Most Honored that they were following the guidance and the correct path, just as they used to swear to the believers in this worldly life. Verily, those who live following on a certain path will most likely die while on it. Thus, they will be resurrected upon their path. The hypocrites will think that their vows will help them with Allah, just as they helped with the people, who were obliged to treat them as they pretended to be, Muslim. This is why Allah said, 4And they think that they have something} meaning, on account of swearing to their Lord (that they used to be believers). Allah rebukes this idea of theirs; 4Verily, they are liars!} stressing that they are lying, Allah then said;

535 Surah 58. Al-Muiadilah (14-19) (Part-28 J etcimaz oto ^Jt>*1^]!jl «XjI* .4! »* .<' »,, > > ""V-' /> .M
k: 1 <«•'> <"1 .1 *•' * ?f^« •»> o '•-^cfi'Wjv^~j»4li 102^ryA>- ii£\$CZ'JVJ0j&ljalul&X lilLili L-l)t
^tU 1 7^ 4The Shaytan has overpowered them . So he has made them forget the remembrance
of Allah.} meaning, Shaytan has taken over their hearts to the point that he made them forget Allah the
Exalted and Most Honored. This is what the devil does to those whom he controls. Abu Dawud
recorded that Abu Ad- Darda' said that he heard the Messenger of Allah say, ^j '£} j. j VI |*4-> fli- 't
ijjj iiU4lji v^ ji 4JJJI U4i 4jpUAJi 4*ri& •Any f/iree in a village or desert among whom the Salah is
not called for, will have the Shaytan control them . Therefore, adhere to the Jama'ah, for the
wolf eats from the strayed sheep. Za'idah added that As-Sa'ib said that Jama'ah, refers to, "Praying in
congregation." 111 Allah the Exalted said, Vj*: 4They are the party of Shaytan.} referring to those who
are controlled by the devil and, as a result, forgot the remembrance of Allah, Abu Dawud 1 :371 .

<20. Those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, they will be among those most humiliated. 421.
Allah has decreed: "Verily, I and My Messengers shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful,
Almighty.> <22 . You will not find any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship
with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even though they were their fathers or their sons or
their brothers or their kindred. For such He has written faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with
Rih from Himself. And He will admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow, to dwell therein
(forever). Allah is well pleased with them, and they are well pleased with Him. They are the party
of Allah. Verily, the party of Allah will be the successful . The Opponents of Allah and His Messenger
are the Losers; Allah and His Messenger shall prevail. Allah the Exalted asserts that the rebellious and
stubborn disbelievers who defy Him and His Messenger, those who do not embrace the religion and
stay away from Truth, are in one area, while the guidance is in another area, i'uSti 4 iThey will be
among those most humiliated.> they are among the miserable, the cast out, banished from goodness;
they are the humiliated ones in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, iAllah has decreed: "Verily, I and
My Messengers shall be the

537 Surah 58. Al-Muiadilah (20-22) (Part-28) victorious meaning, He has decreed, written in the First
Book, and decided in the decree that He has willed - which can never be resisted, changed or prevented
- that final victory is for Him, His Book, His Messengers and the faithful believers, in this life and the
Hereafter: iil 4Surely, the (good) end is for those who have Taqwa.^l 1:49), ^ fju |*?j C-j)' 4 i^»» lid ip
iVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in the life of this world
and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth, the Day when their excuses will be of no profit to
the wrongdoers. Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode.^ (40:51-52) Allah said here,
iAllah has decreed: "Verily, I and My Messengers shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-
Powerful, Almighty> meaning, the Almighty, All-Powerful has decreed that He shall prevail over His
enemies. Indeed, this is the final judgement and a matter ordained; the final triumph and victory are for
the believers in this life and the Hereafter. The Believers do not befriend the Disbelievers. Allah the
Exalted said, & SfcZ. i? ^Py A Cj 14 v> ApJsP J>' -hpS*-1 j' iYou will not find any people who believe
in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even
though they were their fathers or their sons or their brothers or their kindred. Meaning, do not befriend
the deniers, even if they are among the closest relatives. Allah said,

4 U S2S M « S\$ ^ ih2 £t {&.:££ is^ ij&S o» 'Ai^ <(Let not the believers take the disbelievers as friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that will never be helped by Allah in any way, except if you indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself. (3:28), and, Jyl) fcr&'j f\$3y-)j 3^» oj. J»^ 3 UA-5" fjjK jAf. *4 ill(j ii(v^i (S' 4Say: If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your wives, your kindred, the wealth that you have gained, the commerce in which you fear a decline, and the dwellings in which you delight are dearer to you than Allah and His Messenger, and striving hard and fighting in His cause, then wait until Allah brings about His decision (torment). And Alldlt guides not the people who are the rebellious.>(9:24) Said bin 'Abdul-'Aziz and others said that this Ayah, 4\$;A Q 14 iYou will not find any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day...} was revealed in the case of Abu Ubaydah 'Amir bin 'Abdullah bin Al-Jarrah when he killed his disbelieving father, during the battle of Badr. ' This is why when Umar bin Al-Khattab placed the matter of KhUafah in the consultation of six men after him, he said; "If Abu Ubaydah were alive, I would have appointed him the Khallfah." It was also said that the Ayah, C !?^=> jSj> }even though they were their fathers}, was revealed in the case of [1 ' See Al-Isabah under the biography of 'Amir bin 'Abdullah bin Al- Jarrah. There it is reported from 'Abdullah bin Shawdhab. Ibn Hajar said that At-Tabarani had a good chain for it. However, these narrations are Mursal.

539Surah 58. Al-Mujadilah (20-22) (Part-28 Abu 'Ubaydah, when he killed his father during the battle of Badr, while the Ayah, ior their sons} was revealed in the case of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq when he intended to kill his (disbelieving) son, 'Abdur-Rahman, (during Badr), while the Ayah, i&M ior their brothers} was revealed about the case of Mus'ab bin 'Umayr, who killed his brother, TJbayd bin TJmayr, during Badr, and that the Ayah, ior their kindred} was revealed about the case of 'Umar, who killed one of his relatives during Badr, and also that this Ayah was revealed in the case of Hamzah, 'Ali and Ubaydah bin Al- Harith. They killed their close relatives 'Utbah, Shaybah and Al- Walld bin Utbah that day. Allah knows best. A similar matter is when Allah's Messenger jg consulted with his Companions about what should be done with the captives of Badr. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq thought that they should accept ransom for them so the Muslims could use the money to strengthen themselves. He mentioned the fact that the captured were the cousins and the kindred, and that they might embrace Islam later on, by Allah's help. 'Umar said, "But I have a different opinion, O Allah's Messenger! Let me kill so-and-so, my relative, and let 'Ali kill 'Aql ('Ali's brother), and so-and-so kill so-and-so. Let us make it known to Allah that we have no mercy in our hearts for the idolators." Allah said, ^*-4 (Vj-i Cr+W p-frA* 4 iFor such He has written faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with Ruh from Himself.) means, those who have the quality of not befriending those who oppose Allah and His Messenger jg, even if they are their fathers or brothers, are those whom Allah has decreed faith,

meaning, happiness, in their hearts and made faith dear to their hearts and happiness reside therein. As-Suddi said that the Ayah, 4He has written faith in their hearts means, "He has placed faith in their hearts." Ibn 'Abbas said that, y > > f - -'y v iand strengthened them with Ruh from Himself.) means, "He gave them strengths." Allah's statement, 4And He will admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow, to dwell therein . Allah is well pleased with them, and they are well pleased with Him.} was explained several times before. Allah's statement. 4Allah is well pleased with them, and they are well pleased with Him.} contains a beautiful secret. When the believers became enraged against their relatives and kindred in Allah's cause, He compensated them by being pleased with them and making

them pleased with Him from what He has granted them of eternal delight, ultimate victory and encompassing favor. Allah's statement, 4'oy^As pi «iit Cfj*^ yI jit Cjj? 4They are the party of Allah. Verily, the party of Allah will be the successful.} indicates that they are the party of Allah, meaning, His servants who are worthy of earning His honor. AUAh's statement, jU Co? 4Verily, the party of Allah will be the successful.}

asserts their success, happiness and triumph in this life and the Hereafter, in contrast to those, who are the party of the devil, ius f \^ iVerily, the party of Shaytan will be the losers!}

Surah 59: Al-Hashr

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Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5826–5830]

Ibn ‘Abbas used to call this chapter, ‘Surah Bani An-Nadir.’* 1 ' Said bin Mansur recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, “I asked Ibn ‘Abbas about Surat Al-Hashr and he said, It was revealed about Bani An-Nadir.” Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded it using another chain of narration from Ibn ‘Abbas.12* Al-Bukhari also recorded it from Abu ‘Awanah, from Abu Bishr from Said bin Jubayr, who said, “I asked Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Surat Al-Hashr?’ He said, ‘Surah Bani An-Nadir.’”*3 -W* 2' In the Name of Allah, the Most Graciously, the Most Merciful. xsj\ ji f 4 4 c A cr-> ipv* o' sJji oj oj 1*^ (*r6?. Vfy** (£>*» 4 1): > <-*»• 61 (v+OU J# 61 (*rj'-'**' iiUII jl Xjlj \$i Jtij 6*j Ayvj kili'j jU' 4.U* j LjjJl J Oilj jje ilj 61 U jujl 2ulf 6j» 6>4lj 41 . Whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth glorifies Allah. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise 42 . He it is Who drove out the disbelievers among the People of the Scripture from their homes at the first gathering. You did not think that they would get out. And they thought that their fortresses would defend them from Allah! But Allah reached 111 Fath Al-Bari8 :497 [2 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :497 , Muslim 4 :2322 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :497

them from a place whereof they expected it not, and He cast terror into their hearts so that they demolished their own dwellings with their own hands and the hands of the believers. Then take admonition, O you with eyes.} 43. And had it not been that Allah had decreed exile for them, He would certainly have punished them in this world; and in the Hereafter theirs shall be the torment of the Fire.} 44. That is because they opposed Allah and His Messenger. And whosoever opposes Allah, then verily, Allah is Severe in punishment.} 45. What you cut down of the Linah, or you left them standing on their stents, it was by leave of Allah, and in order that He might disgrace the rebellious.} Everything glorifies Allah in its own way Allah states that everything that exists in the heavens and on the earth praises, glorifies, reveres and prays to Him and affirms His Oneness. Allah said in another Ayah, V Vj 0* X >jV'j ZJfA *i gj>} 4The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification.>(17:44) Allah's statement, %} 4And He is the Almighty} meaning of invincible majesty, 4the All-Wise.} in what He decrees and legislates. The End that Bani An-Nadir suffered Allah said, £} 4He it is Who drove out the disbelievers among the People of the Scripture} referring to the Jewish tribe of Bani An-Nadir, according to Ibn

‘Abbas, Mujahid, Az-Zuhri and several others.^ When the Messenger of Allah jg migrated to Al-Madlnah, he made a peace treaty with the Jews stipulating that he would not fight them and they would not fight him. They soon betrayed the treaty that they made with Allah's Messenger jg. Therefore, Allah sent His torment down on them; it can never be averted, and His appointed destiny touched them; it can never be resisted. The Prophet jg forced them to evacuate and abandon their fortified forts that Muslims

did not think they would ever control. The Jews thought that their fortifications will save them from Allah's torment, but they did not help them against Allah in the least. Then, that which they did not expect came to them from Allah, and Allah's Messenger jg forced them to leave Al-Madlnah. Some of them went to Adhri'at in the area of Ash-Sham, which is the area of the grand Gathering and Resurrection, while others went to Khaybar. The Prophet jg allowed them to evacuate their forts and take whatever their camels could carry. They destroyed the property that they could not carry. This is why Allah the Exalted said, ithey demolished their own dwellings with their own hands and the hands of the believers. Then take admonition, O you with eyes.) meaning, "Contemplate the end of those who defied Allah's command, contradicted His Messenger and denied His Book. See how Allah's humiliating torment struck them in this life, as well as, the painful torment that Allah has reserved for them in the Hereafter." Abu Dawud recorded that 'Abdur-Rahman bin Ka'b bin Malik said that one of the Prophet's Companions said, "The Quraysh idolators wrote to 'Abdullah bin Ubayy and those who were still worshipping idols among the tribes of Al-Aws and Al- Khazraj. The Messenger of Allah m was in Al-Madlnah at the time, before the battle of Badr occurred. They wrote: 'You have given refuge to our citizen. We swear by Allah, you should fight him, or we will expel you or gather all our forces, until m At-Tabari 23 :262

we kill your soldiers and take your women captive.' When the news of this threat reached 'Abdullah bin Ubayy and the idolaters of Al-Aws and Al-Khazraj, they prepared to fight the Prophet jg. The news of this reached the Prophet jg and he went to them saying, "77ie threat of the Quraysh has caused you extreme anxiety! The Quraysh cannot cause you more hartn than what you will cause yourselves by your actions. Do you want to fight your children and brethren ?» When they heard these words from the Prophet jg, they dis- persed and the news of what happened reached the Quraysh idolaters. After the battle of Badr, the Quraysh idolators wrote to the Jews of Al-Madlnah, 'You have armor and forts! You should fight our citizen or we will do such and such to you, and nothing will prevent us from acquiring your women.' The news of this letter also reached the Prophet jg and Bani An-Nadlr intended to betray their treaty. Bani An-Nadlr sent a message to the Prophet jg asking him to come with thirty of his Companions to meet thirty of their rabbis half way, from either side. They said that the rabbis would listen to the Prophet jg and if they believe in him, the rest of Bani An- Nadlr would believe. They intended to kill the Messenger jg, and Allah informed His Messenger jg of this plot before they could harm him. The next day, the Prophet jg gathered his forces and laid siege to their area, saying to them, Ajii Yj tEXj> j Y 4ilj "By Allah ! You will not be safe until and unless you renew your peace treaty with me .» They refused to do so, and the Prophet jg fought them the rest of that day. The next morning, the Prophet jg laid siege to the tribe of Bani Qurayzah and left Bani An-Nadlr alone that day. The Prophet jg ordered Bani Qurayzah to sign a new treaty of peace, and they accepted. The Prophet jg left Bani Qurayzah and went back to Bani An-Nadir with his forces and fought them until they agreed to surrender in return for safe

passage out of Al-Madlnah. Bani An-Nadir evacuated Al- Madinah and took with them all whatever their camels could cany from their furniture, including even the wood and the doors to their houses. The date trees of Bani An-Nadir were granted to the Messenger jg by Allah when He said, iri & Ayo »li(4And what Allah gave as booty to His Messengerfrom them - for this you made no expedition with either cavalry or camelry that is, what you earned without a fight. The Prophet ag divided most of their

trees between the emigrants and gave to only two men who were poor from Al-Ansar. He did not give the Ansar any of it, except for these two men. The Prophet jg kept a part of the war booty for himself and that part of charity of the Prophet jg was transferred to the administration of his daughter's children, i.e., children of Fatimah.” [I ' However, let us summarize the battle of Bani An-Nadir here. From Allah alone we seek help.

The Reason behind the Battle of Bani An-Nadir

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5830–5865]

After the seventy Companions whom the Prophet jg sent to teach the Qur'an were killed at the area of Bi'r Ma'unah, excluding 'Amr bin Umayyah Ad-Damn, who killed two men from the tribe of Bani 'Amir on his way back to Al-Madinah. He did not know that these two men had a promise of safe passage from Allah's Messenger jg. When he went back to Al-Madlnah, he told the Prophet sg what happened and the Prophet jg said, •U&V JAfj diii jiJ» “You have killed two men, I shall pay the blood money for them. Bani An-Nadir and Bani 'Amir were allies and had treaties. The Prophet jg asked Bani An-Nadir to help pay the blood money for the two dead men. The area of Bani An-Nadir was in a suburb of Al-Madinah, a few miles to the east.¹² ' Abu DSwud 3 :404 Ad-Durrari fi Ikhtisar Al-Maghazi was-Siyar 180, 181, and Ibn Hisham 3 :195. This narration is Mursal.

Stlrah 59. Al-Hashr (1-5) (Part-28 547 In his book of Sirah, Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said; “Then the Messenger of Allah jg went to Bani An-Nadlr to ask them for financial help to pay the blood money of the two men from Bani 'Amir, who were killed by 'Amr bin Umayyah Ad-Damri. They had a promise of safe passage from the Prophet according to the (subnarrator) Yazld bin RCtman. Bani An-Nadlr and Bani 'Amir had a treaty and were allies. When Allah's Messenger jg went to Bani An-Nadlr asking them for help to pay the blood money for the two men, they said, Yes, O Abu Al-Qasim! We will help you, since you asked us for help.' Yet, when they met each other in secret, they said, You will not find a better chance with this man than this,' while the Messenger of Allah jgg was sitting next to a wall of one of their houses. They said, 'Who will ascend this wall and drop a stone on this man and rid us of his trouble?' 'Amr bin Jihash bin Ka*b volunteered and ascended the wall of the house to drop a stone on the Messenger jg. The Messenger of Allah was sitting with several of his Companions, such as Abu Bakr, TJmar and 'Ali. The news of this plot was conveyed to the Prophet from heaven, and he stood up and went back to Al-Madlnah. When the Companions thought that the Messenger was absent for a long time, they went to see where he was and saw a man coming from Al-Madlnah. They asked him, and he said that he saw the Prophet jg enter Al-Madlnah. The Messenger's Companions went to him, and he told them the news of the betraying plot that the Jews planned against him. He ordered them to prepare for war and to march forth to Bani An-Nadlr. The Prophet^ gathered his forces and marched to the area of Bani An-Nadlr, who had taken refuge in their fortified forts. The Messenger j|| ordered their date trees be cut down and burned. The Jews heralded at the Prophet, 'O Muhammad! You used to forbid mischief in the earth and blame those who did it. Why is it that you had the date trees cut down and burned?' Meanwhile, 'Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, Wadi'ah, Malik bin Abi Qawqal, Suwayd, Da*is and several other men who all belonged to the tribe of Al-Khazraj bin Bani 'Awf, sent a message to

Bani An-Nadlr saying, 'Be firm and strong. We will never abandon you. If you are fought against, we will fight

along with you and if you are forced to leave Al-Madinah, we will accompany you.' The Jews waited for this claim of support, but the hypocrites did not deliver. Allah cast terror in the hearts of the Jews. They asked the Messenger jg to allow them safe passage out of Al-Madinah and to spare their lives. In return, they would only take what their camels could carry, except for weapons. The Prophet sg agreed. The Jews collected all the wealth their camels could transport. One of the Jews would demolish his own house around its door, so that he could carry the door on the back of his camel. Bani An-Nadir moved to Khaybar, and some of them went to Ash-Sham. They left all that remained behind for the Messenger of Allah jg, who had control over how it was to be divided. The Prophet jg divided it between the emigrants and none of Al-Ansar got a share, except for Sahl bin Hunayf and Abu Dujanah Simak bin Kharashah. They said that they were poor and the Messenger of Allah jg gave them their share. Only two men from Bani An-Nadir embraced Islam, Yamin bin Umayr bin KaTa bin 'Amr bin Jihash and Abu Sa'd bin Wahb and they saved their wealth due to their acceptance of Islam." Ibn Ishaq continued, "Some of the offspring of Yamin narrated to me that the Messenger of Allah said to Yamin, ii p-® 'tL** ji' y p' "Have you not heard what your cousin plotted to do against me?n Yamin bin TJmayr promised someone a reward if he killed his cousin 'Amr bin Jihash, and someone killed him, according to their claim",1, Ibn Ishaq then said, "All of Surat Al-Hashr was revealed about Bani An-Nadir." A similar story was recorded by Yunus bin Bukayr from Ibn Ishaq. 121 Allah's statement, 4He it is Who drove out the disbelievers among the People of the Scripture refers to Bani An-Nadir, This chain is not authentic. Ibn Hisham 3:199-202.

i'Jtt Sk ot¥ 4froin their homes at the first gathering.} Allah said, 4* c? 4You did not think that they ivould get out.} i.e., within the few days you laid siege against them. The Companions had surrounded their forts for only six days, and their forts were fortified and formidable. This is why Allah the Exalted said, && J Jil L-uti dill tj-"- [rbr 4And they tlwught that their fortresses would defend themfrom Allah! But Allah reached themfrom a place where they expected it not.} meaning, there came to them from Allah what they did not expect or anticipate. Allah said in another Ayah, >_ii-Jl jC-ji- 'j*s «i' jti AjXi ot v oi 'r'l *y iThose before them indeed plotted, but Allah struck at the foundation of their building, and then the roof fell down upon them, from above them, and the torment overtook them from directions they did not perceive.}[16:26) Allah said, iand He cast terror into their hearts} means, Allah cast fear, terror and fright in their hearts, and why would that not happen to them? He who was given victory, by Allah frightening his enemies the distance of a month, laid siege to them. May Allah's peace and blessings be on the Prophet. As in Ibn Ishaq's explanation - which preceded; 4that they demolished their own dwellings with their own hands and the hands of the believers.} the Jews brought down what they wanted to transport from

their roofs and doors, so that they could carry them on camels. Similar was said by TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr, 'Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and several others . Allah's statement, 4 rr^ iit Cl£ jl iAnd had it not been that Allah had decreed exilefor them, He would certainly have punished them in this world;} meaning, if it was not for the fact that Allah had already decreed that they would evacuate Al-Madlnah, leaving behind their homes and wealth, He would have sent another type of punishment upon

them, such as being killed and captured. This was said by Az-Zuhri. 'Urwah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd said that Allah decreed that the Jews would be punished in the life of this world and face the torment of the fire of Hell He prepared for them in the Hereafter. ,2) Allah said, 4j* 4 iand in the Hereafter theirs shall be the torment of the Fire.} meaning, it is a matter ordained that they will surely face, iThat is because they opposed Allah and His Messenger.} means, Allah prepared this specific punishment and sent His Messenger sg and his Companions against them, because they defied Allah and His Messenger and denied the good news that Allah sent forth in the Books of previous Messengers regarding the coming of Muhammad jg. The Jews knew these facts about Muhammad jg just as they knew their own children. Allah said. iol ill J>j} iAnd whosoever opposes Allah, then verily, Allah is Severe in punishment.} I 1 ' Al-Qurtubi 18 :4. Ar-Razi 29:245.

The Propheti Cut down the Date Trees of the Jews by the Leave of Allah Allah said, l ' }• }LJ (ji y'mhi iWhat you cut down of the Ltnah, or you left them standing on their stems, it was by leave of Allah, and in order that He might disgrace the rebellious Linah is an especially good type of date tree. Abu TJbaydah said that Linah is a different kind of dates than 'Ajwah and Sami. ' Several others said that Linah refers to every type of date fruits, except for the 'Ajwah (ripen dates), while Ibn Jarir said that it refers to all kinds of date trees. 121 Ibn Jarir quoted Mujahid saying that it also includes the Buwayrah type. When the Messenger of Allah laid siege to Bani An-Nadlr, to humiliate them and bring fear and terror to their hearts, he ordered their date trees to be cut down. Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Yazld bin Raman, Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "Bani An-Nadlr sent a message to the Messenger 3g, saying that he used to outlaw mischief in the earth, so why did he order that their trees be cut down? Allah sent down this honorable Ayah stating that whatever Linah was felled or left intact by the Muslims, has been done by His permission, will, leave and pleasure to humiliate and disgrace the enemy and degrade them."*31 Mujahid said, "Some of the emigrants discouraged others from chopping down the date trees of Jews, saying that they were war spoils for Muslims. The Qur'an approved of the actions of those who discouraged and those who approved of cutting these trees, stating that those who cut them or did not, did so only by Allah's leave." There is also a Hadith narrated from the Prophet jg with this meaning.141 An-Nasal recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4 l Wi. U jl ilj Ji y ~-<k» Ar-Razi 29:246. At-Tabari 23:268. At-Tabari 23:271. At-Tabari 23:271.

iWhat you cut down of the Linah, or you left them standing on their stems, it was by leave of Allah, and in order that He might disgrace the rebellious .> "They forced them to come down from their forts and were ordered to cut their trees cut down. So the Muslims hesitated, and some of them said, We cut down some and left some. We must ask Allah's Messenger jg if we will earn a reward for what we cut and if we will be burdened for what we left intact.' Allah sent down this Ayah, iWhat you cut down ofthe Linah, or you left them standing on their stems, it was by leave ofAllah\$."ll] Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg ordered that the date trees of Bani An-Nadir be cut down and burned . The Two Sahihs collected a similar narration.*3 Al-Bukhari recorded that 'Abdullah bin Umar said, "Bani An-Nadir and Bani Qurayzah fought {against the Prophet jg), and the Prophet jg exiled Bani An-Nadir and allowed Bani Qurayzah to remain in their area until later, when the Prophet fought against Qurayzah. Their men were executed and their women, children and wealth were confiscated and divided among Muslims. Some of them, however, were saved because they returned to the Prophet's side, who granted them asylum, and they embraced Islam. All of the Jews of Al-Madinah,

Bani Qaynuqa*, the tribe of ‘Abdullah bin Salam, Bani Harithah and the rest of the Jewish tribes in Al-Madinah were exiled.”*4 The Two Sahihs also recorded from Ibn ‘Umar that the Messenger of Allah jg burned down the date trees of Bani An- Nadir and had them cut down the date palms of Al-Buwayrah. Allah the Exalted and Most Honored revealed this Ayah, ZsJQj\$ if *1\$ f j. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:483. Similar was recorded by At-Tirmidhi under the Tafsir of this Ayah. Ahmad 2 .7 . •3| MusUm 3:1365. * Path Al-Bari 7 :383

e&m *rv <mmwL lyLi, 'j * - Z\ Z-^aJij a-. !_IL^Lf^j i_jL 4l>1clilL tjvL-iil \ diijiLi y*J& t \$ fi-4 ^ ioi 4ilo^dil|yj(j -/. » >4 • ^ > \f/’ « Ji./i/ #/^ { ^ > i'-u-'L 'T'i4 •!' tr<-i ' . > " yaJU'i'jv^ ' j > < -i; s, ii{ ; >.:(-• f>'.f >— i^ > < •»-{ JjXj <o)l <ui< ylj <c* yJLf-' Uj ijj >o iWhat you cut down of the Linah, or you left them standing on their stems, it was by leave of Allah, and in order that He might disgrace the rebellious.y* l] Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that the battle of Bani An- Nadlr occurred after the battles of Uhud and Bi'r Ma'unah. pri ‘AjrO d* au' *li' ty^ % ft £ J&ip Sim y?i 0 jc iitj ip y ‘ipj jt ill iSl Z ^ J->j i£ji> v!£^h a£^* 4*^ Cft & &X #Sif X,, P>X , /V. / V - < ujj iSjj ^ S£f p; Zjp f0j\ 46. And what Allah gave as booty (Fai') to His Messengerfrom them - for this you made no expedition with either cavalry or camelry. But Allah gives power to His Messengers over whomsoever He wills. And Allah is Able to do all things.} 47. What Allah gave as booty (Fai') to His Messengerfrom the people of the townships - it is for Allah, His Messenger, the kindred, the orphans, the poor, and tlte wayfarer, in order that it may not become a fortune used by the rich among you. And whatsoever the Messenger gives you, take it; and whatsoever he Fath Al-Bari 7 :383 , MusUm 3 :1365

forbids you, abstain (from it). And have Taqwd of Allah verily, Allah is Severe in punishment.} The FaVandhow it is spent Allah the Exalted explains the regulations for Fai’, the booty that the Muslims acquire from the disbelievers, without fighting them or using cavalry and camelry in war against them. For instance, the booty collected from Bani An-Nadir was not acquired because of fighting them using horses and camels. The Muslims did not fight Bani An-Nadir in battle, but Allah forced them out of their forts on account of the fear that He placed in their hearts for Allah’s Messenger jg. Therefore, it was Fai’ that Allah awarded His Messenger, with his discretion to spend it however he sees fit. Indeed, the Prophet spent the Fai’ on righteous causes and for the benefit of Muslims in the areas that Allah mentioned in this Ayat, 4(*rJ Li? t\)} iAnd what Allah gave as booty (Fai') to His Messenger from them} meaning, from Bani An-Nadir, i'j^ Li SZIZji ftL} 4for this you made no expedition with either cavalry camelry.} refering to using camels, or iBut Allah gives power to His Messengers over whomsoever He wills. And Allah is Able to do all things.} mean, Allah is powerful and cannot be resisted or opposed; He is the Compeller over all things. Allah the Exalted said, Aisjft\$ bt -AfL& iSl ft} iWhat Allah gave as booty (Fai') to His Messenger from the people of the townships} meaning, from all the villages and areas that are conquered in this manner; the booty collected from them falls under the same ruling as the booty acquired from Bani An-Nadir. This is

555Surah 59. Al-Hashr (6-7) (Part-28) why Allah the Exalted said, uyti tfjJJ <£ji) iit is for Allah, His Messenger, the kindred, the orphans, the poor, and the wayfarer until its end and the following Ayah. mentioning the ways the Fai’ should be spent. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Umar said, “The wealth of Bani An-Nadlr was of the Fai' type that Allah awarded His Messenger jg and for which the Muslims did not have to use cavalry or camelry. Therefore, it was for the Messenger of Allah sg, and he used it for

the needs of his family for a year at a time, and the rest was used to buy armors and weapons used in the cause of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored.”¹¹¹ Ahmad collected the short form of this story. The Group, with the exception of Ibn Majah, collected this Hadith. Abu Dawud recorded that Malik bin ‘Aws said, “While I was at home, the sun rose high and it got hot. Suddenly the messenger of ‘Umar bin Al-Khattab came to me and I went along with him and entered the place where Umar was sitting on a bedstead made of date-palm leaves and without a mattress. He said when I went in, ‘O Malik! Some of your people’s families came to me due to their famine, and I have ordered that relief aid should be given to them, so take it and distribute it among them.’ I said, ‘I wish that you ordered someone else to do it.’ He said, ‘Take it.’ Then Yarfa (the servant of ‘Umar) came saying, ‘O Commander of the faithful! May I admit ‘Uthman bin ‘Affan, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin ‘Awf, Az- Zubayr bin Al-‘Awwam and Sa’d bin Abi Waqqas?’ ‘Umar said, ‘Yes,’ and they came in. After a while Yarfa came again and said, ‘O Commander of the faithful! May I admit Al-‘Abbas and ‘Ali?’ Umar said, ‘Yes.’ So, they were admitted and Al-‘Abbas said, ‘O Chief of the believers! Judge between me and this one (i.e., ‘Ali).’ The group (being ‘Uthman and his companions) said, ‘O Chief of the believers! Judge between them and relieve both of them from each other.’ I (Malik bin Aws) thought that [1] Ahmad 1 : 25. 121 Fath Al-Bari 8 :498, Muslim 3 :1376, Abu Dawud 3 :371 , Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 5 :381 , and An-Nasal 7 :132

they asked the four men to come in before them for this purpose. ‘Umar said, “Be patient!” He then asked the group (‘Uthman and his companions), ‘I ask you by Allah by Whose permission the heaven and the earth exist, do you know that Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) said, ‘Our (the Prophet’s) property will not be inherited. Whatever we leave, is charity?’ The group said, “He said so.” ‘Umar then turned to ‘Ali and Al- Abbas and said, ‘I beseech you by Allah by Whose permission the heaven and the earth exist, do you know both that Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) said, ‘Our (the Prophets’) property will not be inherited. Whatever we leave, is charity?’ They replied, ‘He said so.’ ‘Umar then said, ‘Allah bestowed on His Messenger (ﷺ) a special favor unlike what he gave all other people. Allah the Exalted said, ‘Our (the Prophets’) property will not be inherited. Whatever we leave, is charity.’ And what Allah gave as booty (Fai) to His Messenger from them - for this you made no expedition with either cavalry or camelry. But Allah gives power to His Messengers over whomsoever He wills. And Allah is Able to do all things.’ Therefore, this property, the booty collected from Bani An- Nadlr, was especially given to Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ). However, by Allah, neither did he take possession of it and leave you, nor did he favor himself with it to your exclusion. Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) took the yearly expenses from it for himself and his family and left the rest in the Muslim Treasury.’ He then asked the group, ‘I ask you by Allah with Whose permission the heavens and earth exist, do you know this?’ They replied, “Yes.” ‘Umar then said to ‘Ali and Al-‘Abbas, ‘I ask you by Allah, with Whose permission that heavens and earth exist, do you know this?’ They said, “Yes.” ‘Umar added, When Allah took His Prophet (ﷺ) unto Him, Abu Bakr said: I am the

successor of Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ)! Then you both came to Abu Bakr asking for your (Al-‘Abbas’) share of inheritance from your nephew, and he (‘Ali) asked for his wife’s share from her father’s inheritance. Abu Bakr said: Allah’s Messenger (ﷺ) said, ‘Our (the Prophets’) property will not be inherited. Whatever we leave, is charity.’” Allah knows that Abu Bakr was true, pious, rightly guided and a follower of what was right. So, Abu Bakr assumed the responsibility of that

property. When Abu Bakr died, I said: I am the successor of Allah's Messenger and the successor of Abu Bakr. So I managed it as long as Allah allowed me to manage it. Then you both ('Ali and Al-'Abbas) came to talk to me, bearing the same claim and presenting the same case, asking for that property. I said to you: I am ready to hand over this property to you if you wish. I will do so on the condition that you will take a pledge before Allah's that you will manage it in the same way as Allah's Messenger used to. So, both of you agreed and on that condition I handed it over to you. Now you come to me to render a different judgement over the property than the one I made before. By Allah, I will never give any decision other than what I have already given, until the Last Hour begins. If you are unable to manage it, then return it to me, and I will do the job on your behalf.”¹¹¹ They recorded this from the Hadith of Az-Zuhri. ¹²¹ Allah said, *ipIME %\& -i iin* order that it may not become a fortune used by the rich among you.} means, *We made the expenditures for the Fai' like this, so that the wealth does not remain among the wealthy, who would spend it as they wish and desire and give none of it to the poor.' Abu Dawud 365. ¹²¹ Fath Al-Bari 13:290, Muslim 3:1377, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:233, and An-Nasal.

558 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Ordering Obedience of the Messenger ^ in All Commands and Prohibitions Allah the Exalted said, *4&U£p- Cj 4^11pK Xfr i*And whatsoever the Messenger gives you, take it; and whatsoever he forbids you, abstain (from it).} meaning, “whatever the Messenger commands you, then do it and whatever he forbids you, then avoid it. Surely, He only commands righteousness and forbids evil.’ Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud said, “Allah curses women who practice tattooing and those who get themselves tattooed, and the women who remove the hair from their eyebrows and faces and those who make artificial spaces between their teeth in order to look more beautiful, whereby changing Allah’s creation.” His statement reached a woman from Bani Asad called, Umm Ya’qub, who came to ‘Abdullah and said, “I have come to know that you have cursed such and such?” He replied, “Why should I not curse those whom Allah’s Messenger has cursed and who are cursed in Allah’s Book!” Umm Ya’qub said, “I have read the whole Qur’an, but did not find in it what you say.” He said, “Verily, if you have read the Qur’an, you have found it. Didn’t you read, *p^ p-jf piK t i*And whatsoever the Messenger gives you take it and whatsoever he forbids you, you abstain (from it).}?” She replied, “Yes, I did.” He said, “Verily, Allah’s Messenger *jg* forbade such things.” “She said, “But I think that your wife does these things?” He said, “Go and look at her.” She went and watched her, but could not see anything in support of her claim. She went back to ‘Abdullah bin Mas’ud and said that she did not notice anything on his wife. On that he said, “If my wife was as you thought, I would not keep her with me.” The Two Sahih recorded this from the Hadith of Sufyan Ath-Thawri²¹ As well as a Hadith of Abu Hurayrah, who said that ^ Ahmad 1 :433. |2) Fath Al-Bari 8 :498 , Muslim 3 :1678

559 Surah 59. Al-Hashr (8-10) (Part-28) the Messenger of Allah *sg* said, *, *Uj U <C> Iylli bl «lAflien I* order you to do something, then do as much as you can of it. If I forbid something for you , then shun it.® Allah’s statement, *4Jl^t sit 5^ sit ijiitj^ 4*Have Taqwa of Allah; verily, Allah is Severe in punishment.} means, fear Allah by obeying His orders and refraining from His prohibitions. Surely, Allah is severe in punishment for those who defy Him and reject and disobey His commands as well as, those who commit what He forbids and prohibits. *ttyiyj <i' Jt ydat oyCii pfj-ii C/t U^**4-.*^ ^ (jfbj ^JjojUiilt ^ vlUsJjt Sit Jlj jic av4>j tjJjt US jiajjii 4 S^4 <> o; jSt iSS?Jtj jt-4 ‘irr** <3j» 0'S ^ cgili y**

ULjis 4 ^y~- stSjJt j-ss-t ^SSA>st li> 48. (And there is also a share in this booty) for the poor e? nigrants, who were expelled from their homes and their property, seeking bounties from Allah and (His) good pleasure, and helping Allah and His Messenger. Such are indeed the truthful.} 49. And (it is also for) those who, before them, had homes and had adopted the faith, love those who emigrate to them, and have no jealousy in their breasts for that which they have been given, and give them preference over themselves even though they were in need of that. And whosoever is saved from his own greed, such are they who will be the successful.} 410. And those who came after them say: "Our Lord! Forgive us and our brethren who have preceded us in faith, and put not in our hearts any hatred against those who have believed. Our Lord! You are indeed full of kindness, Most Merciful.} m Fath Al-Bari 8 : 498 , Muslim 2 :975 .

560 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Those Who deserve the FaV\ and the Virtues of the Muhajirin and Al-Ansar Allah states the categories of needy people who also deserve a part of the Fai', oi jycxi o; *L iwho were expelled from their homes and their property, seeking bounties from Allah and (His) good pleasure,} meaning, departed their homes and defied their people, seeking the acceptance of Allah and His favor, iand helping Allah and His Messenger. Such are indeed the truthful.} meaning, 'they are those who were truthful in statement and deed, and they are the chiefs of the Muhajirin.' Allah the Exalted praised the Ansar next and emphasized their virtue, status and honor, preferring to give to others over themselves, even though they were in need, and not feeling enviousness. Allah the Exalted said, i'j*)j oi jj!' _>»je iAnd (it is also for) those who, before them, had homes and had adopted the faith,} referring to those who resided in the city to which the migration occurred, before the emigrants arrived at it, and who embraced the faith before many of the emigrants. "Umar said, "I recommend the Khalifah, who will come after me, to know the rights and virtues of the foremost Muhajirin and to preserve their honor. I also recommend him to be kind to the Ansar, those who resided in the city of Hijrah and embraced the faith beforehand, that he accepts the good that comes from those who do good among them and forgives those among them who commit errors." Al-Bukhari collected this HadithJ ' Path Al-Bari 8 :499 . Similar with At-Tirmidhi , no . 2487

562 Surah 59. Al-Hashr (8-10) (Part-28) Allah said, 4^1 if SJ4.4 i love those who emigrate to them,} indicates that they, on account of their generosity and honorable conduct, loved those who emigrated to them and comforted them with their wealth. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said, "The Muhajirin said, 'O Allah's Messenger! We have never met people like those whom we emigrated to; comforting us in times of scarcity and giving us with a good heart in times of abundance. They have sufficed for us and shared their wealth with us so much so, that we feared that they might earn the whole reward instead of us.' He said, «j4J' f U 'V» «No they won't, as long you thanked them for what they did and invoked Allah for than.u" * 11 I have not seen this version in the other books. Al-Bukhari recorded that Yahya bin Said heard Anas bin Malik, when he went with him to Al-Walid, saying, "The Prophet si called Ansar to divide Al-Bahrayn among them. The Ansar said, "Not until you give a similar portion to our emigrant brothers.' He said, #^1 J ^ | J | S ' ^ ^ * * X "Perhaps , no; but you will soon see people giving preference to others, so remain patient until you meet me (on the Day of Resurrection) Al-Bukhari was alone with this version. He also recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "The Ansar said (to the Prophet si), 'Distribute our date-palms between us and our emigrant brothers.' He replied, 'No.' The Ansar said (to the emigrants), "Look tend to the trees and share the fruits with us.' The emigrants said,

“We hear and obey.”¹³¹ Al-Bukhari, but not Muslim, recorded it. 111 Ahmad 3:200. •2| Fath Al-Bari 7 :146 131 Fath Al-Bari 5:11.

The Ansar never envied the Muhajirin Allah said, jifljyjLi* ojXjC^ iand have no jealousy in their breasts for that which they have been given,} meaning, the Ansar did not have any envy for the Muhajirin because of the better status, rank, or more exalted grade that Allah gave the Muhajirin above them. Allah’s statement, 4that which they have been given,} refers to what the Muhajirin were favored with, according to Qatadah and Ibn Zayd. Selflessness ofthe Ansar Allah said, iand give them preference over themselves even though they were in need of that.} meaning, they preferred giving to the needy rather than attending to their own needs, and began by giving the people before their own selves, even though they too were in need. An authentic Hadith stated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Jijl JL^>* 44J_a!I *The best charity is that given when one is in need and struggling .d This exalted rank is better than the rank of those whom Allah described in His statements, 4*^& t^ iAnd they givefood, inspite of their lovefor it.>(76:8), and, & 30 *' Zj} 4And gives his wealth, in spite oflovefor it.>(2:177) m Abu Dawud 2 :146

The latter give charity even though they love the wealth they give, not that they really need it, nor that it is necessary for them to keep it. The former prefer others to themselves even though they are in need and have a necessity for what they spend in charity. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq gave away all his wealth in charity and Allah’s Messenger asked him, «What did you keep for your family, » and he said, “I kept for them Allah and His Messenger.” Ikrimah (bin Abi Jahl) and two other wounded fighters were offered water when they were injured during the battle of Al- Yarmuk, and each one of them said that the sip of water should be given to another of the three wounded men. They did so even though they were badly injured and craving water. When the water reached the third man, he and the other two died and none of them drank any of the water! May Allah be pleased with them and make them pleased with Him. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, “A man came to the Prophet sg and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Poverty has stuck me.’ The Prophet jg sent a messenger to his wives (to bring something for that man to eat) but they said that they had nothing. Then Allah’s Messenger jg said, a<b I iJLill (IJla Yl® uWho will invite this person or entertain him as a guest tonight; may Allah grant His mercy to him who does so? An Ansari man said, 1, O Allah’s Messenger!’ So he took him to his wife and said to her, ‘Entertain the guest of Allah’s Messenger generously.’ She said, *By Allah ! We have nothing except the meal for my children.’ He said, ‘Let your children sleep if they ask for supper. Then turn off the lamp and we go to bed tonight while hungry.’ She did what he asked her to do. In the morning the Ansari went to Allah’s Messenger sg who said, iiT TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 10:161.

564 Tatsir Ibt Kathir ^ - .iUwi > ill jih Allah wondered (favorably) or laughed at the action of so-and-so and his wife.* Then Allah revealed, h^&h iand they give them preference over themselves even though they were in need of f/wf^.”111 Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in another part of his Sahth. Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal collected this Hadith. In another narration for this Hadith, the Companion’s name was mentioined, it was Abu Talhah Al-Ansari, may Allah be pleased with him.’21 Allah said, \ > -- iAnd whosoever is saved from his own greed, such are they who will be the successfiil.) indicating that those who are saved from being stingy, then they have earned success and a good achievement. Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah jg

said, if* ^iJl \jj£\ oUJfc f lLll jli ji^lJ “Be on your guard against committing oppression, for oppression is a darkness on the Day of Resurrection. Be on your guard against being stingy, for being stingy is what destroyed those who were before you . It made them shed blood and make lawful what was unlawful for them .»*3 * Muslim collected this HadithJ41 FathAl-Bdri8:500. Fath Al-Bari 7:149, Muslim 3:1624, 1625, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :197 , An-Nasat in Al-Kubra 6 :486 Ahmad 3:323. Muslim 4 :1996.

565Surah 59. Al-Hashr (8-10) (Part-28) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Al-Aswad bin Hilal said that a man said to ‘Abdullah (bin Mas'ud), “O Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman! I fear that I have earned destruction for myself.” ‘Abdullah asked him what the matter was and he said, “I hear Allah’s saying, 4 (** ^ dj> J iAnd whosoever is saved from his own greed, such are they zwho will be the successful and I am somewhat a miser who barely gives away anything.” ‘Abdullah said, “That is not the greed Allah mentioned in the Qur’an, which pertains to illegally consuming your brother’s wealth. What you have is miserliness, and it is an evil thing indeed to be a miser.”W Allah said, ^ t J-iil% ^j5>; Si iAnd those who came after them say: "Our Lord! Forgive us and our brethren who have preceded us in faith, and put not in our hearts any hatred against those who have believed. Our Lord! You are indeedfull ofkindness, Most Merciful. This is the third type of believers whose poor most deserve to receive a part of the Fai’. These three types are the Muhajinn, the Ansar and those who followed their righteous lead with excellence. Allah said in another Ayah, l*r «i)i Ofj iAnd of theforemost to embrace Islam of the Muhajinn and the Ansar and also those who followed them exactly, Allah is well- pleased with them as they are well-pleased with Him.>(9:100) The third type are those who followed the Muhajirin and Ansar in their good works, beautiful attributes and who invoke Allah for them in public and secret. This is why Allah the Exalted said in this honorable Ayah, m At-Tabari 28 :29

iAnd those who came after them say}, meaning, the statement that they utter is, 0* iSjtt 4 ijZL <<Jf C2 J-,jit%} \$Our Lord! Forgive us and our brethren who have preceded us in faith, and put not in our hearts any hatred}, meaning, rage or envy, iagainst those who have believed. Our Lord! You are indeed full ofkindness, Most Merciful.} Indeed, it is a beautiful way that Imam Malik used this honorable Ayah to declare that the Raiidah111 who curse the Companions do not have a share in the Fai’ money, because they do not have the good quality of those whom Allah has described here that they say, \p: ctM% 4 ijz. ylS £3 S-& iOur Lord! Forgive us and our brethren who have preceded us in faith, and put not in our hearts any hatred against those who have believed. Our Lord! You are indeed full ofkindness, Most Merciful.} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “They were commanded to invoke Allah to forgive them, but instead, they cursed them!” She then recited this Ayah, Oi _>»! iAnd those wlio came after them say: “Our Lord! Forgive us and our brethren who have preceded us in faith, and put not in our hearts any hatred against those who have believed.”}^ I 1 * A group of Shiites I2 Muslim recorded a similar narration , 4 :23 17

567Surah 59. Al-Hashr (11-17) (Part-28) otV llll 4A—^OjSf< ^ v ^ cyjjJ ^r-Lr^y (lP **>* ^ yu .^ii: Jj ;= •*> ,f.*.s.'-\ < r— .’t.-’j’-i >4 — O^^j>^i.>-.^Uj-U.sbjOJJ 0 jiiitu ^ r’l>JlJ’oi^l’tjUVtl-’^ j ’.«n’< J- ll IK Cft it^ OJ^’ OjIjSj &* ^ tfj fed 45 lii a jji '@o^iS3 ^ j£ iitj . y *>" * >ry * AOgj (*+« oj*J* V lju-1 fAis** <-5l> J> l>*y» jisVf / /> V 15 is; ill d-V dlb <il il v iUjuUl V ,.’^<^“4 » p» -1 y- • vli i* ^ la j’ 4/ 4 *1 W- ;«? £ £\$ gi .#\$; ilf I4pl ^ >+.i ip’i 1J 1^5 02 £{jfr JIT **; _ji 3sX es^ *a\$ J* k \$z iffjj

<\$&#^ jcj 'ill d& ^ a 0' c^ii oe 4*; a dll 4 di; <H. Have you not observed the hypocrites who say to their disbelieving brethren among the People of the Scripture, "If you are expelled, we indeed will go out with you, and we shall never obey anyone against you; and if you are attacked, we shall indeed help you." But Allah is Witness that they verily are liars.} 412. Surely, if they (the Jews) are expelled, never will they (hypocrites) go out with them; and if they are attacked, they will never help them. And (even) if they do help them, they (hypocrites) will turn their backs, and they will not be

568 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr victorious.} 413. Verily, you are more fearful in their breasts than Allah. That is because they are a people who comprehend not.} 424. They fight not against you even together, except in fortified townships, or from behind walls. Their enmity among themselves is very great. You would think they were united, but their hearts are divided. That is because they are a people who understand not.} 425. They are like their immediate predecessors; they tasted the evil result of their conduct, and for them a painful torment.} 426. Like Shaytan, when he says to man: "Disbelieve." But when he disbelieves, Shaytan says: "I am free of you, I fear Allah, the Lord of all that exists!"} 417. So, the end of both will be that they will be in the Fire, abiding therein. Such is the recompense of the wrongdoers.} The False Promise of Support the Hypocrites gave to the Jews Allah states that the hypocrites, 'Abdullah bin Ubayy and his like, sent a messenger to Bani An-Nadîr promising them help. Allah the Exalted said, 4fej24# \4a&\$% jSSs iHave you not observed the hypocrites who say to their friends among the People of the Scripture who disbelieve: "If you are expelled, we indeed will go out with you, and we shall never obey anyone against you; and if you are attacked, we shall indeed help you."} Allah then said, 4But Allah is Witness that they verily are liars.} meaning, the hypocrites lied when they issued this promise, because it was just words that they did not intend to fulfill. Also, what they said they would do, would never have been fulfilled by them, and this is why Allah said,

and if they are attacked, they will never help them.} meaning, the hypocrites will not fight along with the Jews, 4And (even) if they do help them,} and even if the hypocrites did fight along their side, V ylsVf £}£} 4they will turn their backs, and they will not be victorious.} This Ayah contains good news, just as the good news that this following Ayah conveys, Jt t} *-A> 4Verily, you are more fearful in their breasts than Allah.} meaning, the hypocrites fear you more than they fear Allah, as He says; 4Behold! a section of them fear men as they fear Allah or even more.>(4:77) This is why Allah said, \&} 4That is because they are a people who comprehend not.} Allah then said, JL 't . ^ \ '* '.V 4They fight not against you even together, except in fortified townships, or from behind walls.} meaning, they will not fight Muslims except from behind besieged fortified forts, because of their cowardice and fear of Muslims. They only fight when they have to defend themselves (even though they threaten Muslims of reprisals). Allah the Exalted said, 4Their enmity among themselves is very great.} meaning, the enmity they feel against each other is intense,

570 Tafsîr Ibn Kathîr iAtîd make you to taste the violence of one another.^(6:65) Allah said in the Ayah, 45M- J ££ iYou would think they were united, but their hearts are divided.} meaning, even though one might see them combining forces and think that these forces are harmonious, yet in reality, they are divided severely. Ibrahim An-Nakhal said that this Ayah refers to the hypocrites and the People of the Scriptures, "if iThat is because they are a people who understand not.} Allah said. 'fio <3Vj **> at liM iThey are like their immediate predecessors; they tasted the evil result of their conduct, and far from them a

painful torment.} referring to the Jewish tribe of Bani Qaynuqa‘ , according to Ibn ‘Abbas, Qatadah and Muhammad bin Ishaq.*21 The Parable of the Hypocrites and the Jews Allah said, 4-^4 »3y> <35 jff tiu <35 i) iLike Shaytan, when he says to man: "Disbelieve." But when (man) disbelieves, Shaytan says: "I am free of you..." } meaning, the example of the Jews being deceived by the promises of the hypocrites, who said that they will help them if Muslims fight them, is that of the devil. When matters got serious and the Jews were besieged, the hypocrites betrayed them and abandoned them to taste utter defeat. Likewise, the devil lures mankind into disbelief and when they obey him, he disowns them and declares himself free of their actions, saying, C/j Sit jlil At-Tabari 23:293. At-Tabari 23:293.

The Command to have Taqwa and to prepare for the Day of Resurrection Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Mundhir bin Jarir narrated that his father said, “While we were in the company of the Messenger of Allah^ in the early hours of the morning, some people came there who were barefooted, naked, wearing striped woolen clothes, or cloaks, with their swords hung (around their necks). Most of them, nay, all of them, belonged to the tribe of Mudar. The color of the face of the Messenger of Allah jg underwent a change when he saw them in poverty. He then entered (his house) and came out and commanded Bilal to pronounce Adhan. Bilal pronounced Adhan and Iqamah, and the Prophet jg led the prayer. He then addressed them, first reciting, tj-to of* Jii jSE. 4\ J.& 40 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord, Who created you from a single person... } (4:1), until the end of the Ayah. Then he recited the Ayah that is in Surat Al-Hashr. iand let every person look to what he has sent forth for tomorrow,”} He then said, “A man donated his Dinar, his Dirham, from his clothes, from his Sa‘ of wheat, from his Sd‘ of dates” - until he said - “even if it was half a date.” Then a person among the Ansar came there with a moneybag, which his hands could scarcely lift; in fact, his hands could not lift it. Then the people followed continuously, until I saw two heaps of eatables and clothes. I saw the face of the Messenger jg radiate with pleasure, like gold. The Messenger of Allah jg said, JA ji *it frfr Ir* f^X jjjj ^jjj £* ^ '•*<!/•* ji |i| A measure of weight ; four scoops with two hands held together.

iri Ifi ‘^ J?* J “He who sets a good example in Islam, there is a reward for him for this (act of goodness) and reward of that also who acted according to it subsequently, without any deduction from their rewards . Whoever sets in Islam an evil example, there is upon him the burden of that evil and the burden of him also who acted upon it subsequently, without any deduction from their burden Muslim recorded this Hadith via the chain of Shu'bah.121 Therefore, Allah’s statement, 40 you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah}, ordains the Taqwa. of Allah which pertains to obeying what He ordered and staying away from what He forbade. Allah said, 4&^ U 4and let every person look to what he has sent forth far tomorrow,} meaning, hold yourselves accountable before you are recompensed, and contemplate what you have kept for yourselves of good deeds for the Day of your return and being paraded before your Lord, 4Have Taqwa of Allah}, again ordering Taqwa, 4 Varily, Allah is All-Aware of what you do.} Allah asserts that surely, He knows all of your deeds - O mankind - and actions. Nothing that pertains to you ever escapes His observation, nor any matter of yours, whether major or minor, is ever beyond His knowledge, X if -Jr\$3 %} 111 Ahmad 4:358. 121 Muslim 2:704.

4And be not like those who forgot Allah, and He caused them to forget themselves.} meaning, do not forget the remembrance of Allah, the Exalted, otherwise, He will make you forget to perform the good deeds that benefit you in your return, because the recompense is equated with the action. This is why

Allah the Exalted said, M5i p, &£j} iThose are the rebellious.} referring to those who rebel against obedience to Allah, who will earn destruction on the Day of Resurrection and failure upon their return, viU'j 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah. And whosoever does that, then they are the losers.^(63:9) The Residents of Paradise and the Residents of Hell are never Equal Allah said, xsy— 't} 4Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise.} meaning, these two categories of people are never the same with regards to the judgement of Allah, the Exalted, on the Day of Resurrection. Allah said in other Ayat. J. tfp i yr }\\ iOr do those who earn evil deeds think that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds, in their present life and after their death? Worst is the judgement that they make.} (45:21),

575 Surah 59. Al-Hashr (21-24) (Part-28) 4And not equal are the blind and those who see; nor are those who believe and do righteous good deeds and those who do evil. Little do you remember!}(40:58), and, OuLII ulX-iJlT ijLiU q>j3f JjoC iShall We treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds as corrupters on earth? Or shall We treat those who have Taqwa as the wicked?}(38:28) Therefore, Allah asserts that He will honor the righteous and humiliate the sinners, and this is why He said here, jU iUK4^ ilt is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful. that is, they are those who will earn safety and deliverance from the torment of Allah the Exalted and Most Honored. j£.VfMC % U ^ & GJ# i&M} J3\ vi it V y\$&£ oM UP piM dp U \% V 'it £ U jpt is £ Ct&M ^ XP^ ji; 4 c^ : "c.Vt 'i 'pit ^21 . Had We sent down this Qur'an on a mountain, you would surely have seen it humbling itself and rent asunder by the fear of Allah. Such are the parables which We put forward to mankind that they may reflect. 422. He is Allah, beside Whom La ilaha ilia Huwa, the All- Knower of the unseen and the seen . He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 423. He is Allah, beside Whom La ilaha ilia Huwa, Al-Malik, Al-Quddus, As-Salam, Al-Mu'min, Al-Muhaymin, Al-'Aziz, Al-Jabbdr, Al-Mutakabbir . Glory be to Allah! Above all that they associate as partners with Him.} 424. He is Allah, Al-Khaliq, Al-Bari, Al-Musawwir. To Him belong the Best Names . All that is in the heavens and the earth

glorify Him. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise.} Asserting the Greatness of the Qur'an Allah the Exalted emphasizes the greatness of the Qur'an, its high status and of being worthy of making hearts humble and rent asunder upon hearing it, because of the true promises and sure threats that it contains, Ot ^j-*3 * Lii Ujit ft} }Had We sent down this Qur'an on a mountain, you would surely have seen it humbling itself and rent asunder by the fear of Allah.} If this is the case with a mountain which is hard and huge, that if it was made able to comprehend and understand this Qur'an, will feel humble and crumble from fear of Allah the Exalted, then what about you - O mankind? Why do your hearts not feel softness and humbleness from the fear of Allah, even though you understand Allah's command and comprehend His Book? This is why Allah said, qji jiVf Sii} iSuch are the parables which We put forward to mankind that they may reflect.} There is a Hadith of the Mutawatir grade that states that the Messenger of Allah jg had someone make him a Minbar. Before that, he used to stand next to a tree trunk in the Masjid to deliver speeches. So, when the Minbar was made and placed in the Masjid, the Prophet jjg came to deliver a speech and passed the tree trunk, headed towards the Minbar, the tree trunk started weeping, just like an infant. The tree trunk missed hearing the remembrance of Allah and the revelation that were being recited next to it. In one of the narrations for this Hadith, Al-Hasan Al-Basri said after narrating the Hadith, "You - mankind - are more worthy to miss the Messenger of Allah

jjg than the tree trunk!” Likewise, this honorable Ayah asks that if the solid mountains feel humble and Eire rent asunder from the fear of m Fath Al-B&ri 6 :696 , Ad-Darimi 1 :34 , 35

Allah, if it heard Allah’s Speech and comprehended it, what about you - O mankind - who heard the Qur’an and understood it? Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, A, A, JLfdl At 6V (J jj)>} iAnd if there had been a Qur’an with which mountains could be moved, or the earth could be cloven asunder, or the dead could be made to speak.}{13:31) We mentioned the meaning of this Ayah as stating that, if there were a Qur’an that has these qualities, it would be this Qur’an. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, Ojj it aZ* LJ iij J&i 1*1 OJ b&} iAnd indeed, there are stones out of which rivers gush forth, and indeed, there are of them (stones) which split asunder so that water flows from them, and indeed, there are of them which fall downforfear ofAllah.^(2:74) Glorifying Allah the Exalted by mentioning His Names and Attributes Allah the Exalted said, if*jb J* {i+iJfj A&), ^ L?J’ a\$ J*} iHe is Allah, beside Whom La ildha ilia Huwa, the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen. He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} Allah states that He Alone is worthy of worship, there is no Lord or God for the existence, except Him. All that is being worshipped instead of Allah are false deities. Allah is the All-Knower in the unseen and the seen. He knows all that pertains to the creations that we see, and those we cannot see. Nothing in heaven or on earth ever escapes His knowledge, no matter how great or insignificant, big or small, including suits in darkness. Allah’s statement, J*} iHe is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} was duly explained before at the very beginning of this Tafsir,

so it is not necessary to repeat it here, and it asserts that Allah is the Owner of the wide encompassing mercy that entails all of His creation. He is Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahlm of this life and the Hereafter. Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat, iAndMy mercy embraces all things.>(7: 156), 4-JS£ £3; iYonr Lord has written (prescribed) mercyfar Himself. 6:54), and, (Vvi) d«X» 4jj\ 4Say: "In the bounty ofAllah, and in His mercy; - therein let them rejoice." That is better than what (the ivealth) they amass.^(10:58) Allah the Exalted said, i<k3 \ v iaf 4He is Allah, beside Whom La ilaha ilia Huwa, Al-Malik.\$ Al-Malik, meaning “The Owner and King of all things,” Who has full power over them without resistance or hindrance. Allah’s statement, iAl-Quddus meaning “The Pure,” according to Wahb bin Munabbih, while Mujahid and Qatadah said that Al-Quddus means “The Blessed.” * Ibn Jurayj said that Al-Quddus means “HeWhom the honorable angels glorify.”*2 iAs-Salam,} meaning “Free from any defects or shortcomings that lessen or decrease His perfect attributes and actions.” Allah’s statement, At-Tabari 23:302. ’ Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8:123.

iAl-Mu'mitt,} means “Who has granted safety to His servants by promising that He will never be unjust to them,” according to Ad-Dahhak who reported it from Ibn ‘Abbas. 1 11 Qatadah said that Al-Mu’min means that “Allah affirms that His statements are true,”*2 * while Ibn Zayd said that it means, “He attested to His faithful servants’ having faith in Him.”131 Allah’s statement. 4Al-Muhaymin,\$ means, according to Ibn ‘Abbas and others, “The Witness for His servants actions,” that is, the Ever-Watch- er over them.l4 ' Allah said in similar Ayat, iAnd Allah is Witness over all things.}(58:6), \$and moreover Allah is Witness over what they used to <fo.M10:46), and, ils then He (Allah) Who takes charge (guards) of every person and knows all that he has eamed?}(13:33) Allah said, iAl-'Aziz,} meaning that “He is the Almighty, Dominant over all things.” Therefore, His majesty is never violated, due to His might, greatness, irresistible power and pride. Allah said; 4Al-Jabbar, Al-Mutakabbir,} meaning “The

Only One worthy of being the Compeller and Supreme.” There is a Hadith in the Sahih Collection in which Allah said, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8: 123. Af-Tabari 23:303. At-Jabari 23 :303 141 Al-Baghawi 4:326.

«Might is My Izar and pride is My Rida; if anyone disputes any one of them with Me, then I will punish Allah the Exalted said, iGlory be to Allah! (High is He) above all that they associate as partners with Him.}, then He said, Cfjllil jilvjt ii(yt} 4He is Allah, Al-Khaliq, Al-Bari, Al-Musawwir.} Al-Khaliq refers to measuring and proportioning, Al-Bari refers to inventing and bringing into existence what He has created and measured. Surely, none except Allah is able to measure, bring forth and create whatever He wills to come to existence. Allah’s statement, iijQl \$&\} iAl-Khaliq, Al-Bari, Al-Musawwir.} means, if Allah wills something, He merely says to it “be” and it comes to existence in the form that He wills and the shape He chooses, *1- l* Jiyi \$ q} iln whateverform He willed, He put you together>(82:8) Allah describing Himself as being Al-Musawwir, Who brings into existence anything He wills in the shape and form He decides. Al-Asma.*Al-Husna Allah the Exalted said, 4To Him belong Al-Asma’ Al-Husna (the Best Names).} We explained the meaning of this Ayah in the Tafsir of Surat Al-A’raf)2 * The Two Sahih recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 'jl it* tU_-l Uu <u (jj Muslim 4:2023. See volume four, the Tafsir of Slirat Al-A’raf\7 :180]

nAllah the Exalted has ninety-nine Names, one hundred less one; whoever then preserves them, will enter Paradise. Allah is Witr (One) and He likes the WitrJ Everything praises and glorifies Allah Allah’s statement, iaftts 4 £ ’A iAll that is in the heavens and the earth glorify Him> is similar to His other statement, y iCA ui o\> vfeV’j £3’ <1\$^ ^ <77ie seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving .K17:44) Allah’s statement, iand He is Al-'Aziz^ The Almighty, meaning, His greatness is never humbled, ii&i 4Al-Hakim\$ the All-Wise, in His legislation and decrees This is the end of the Tafstr of Surat Al-Hashr. All praise is due to Allah. m Meaning odd numbered things. Fath Al-Bari 11:218, Muslim

Surah 60: Al-Mumtahina

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5866–5867]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Mumtahanah (Chapter - 60) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah 41 . O you who believe! Take not My enemies and your enemies as protecting friends, showing affection towards them, while they have disbelieved in what has come to you of the truth, and have driven out the Messenger and yourselves because you

believe in Allah, your Lord! If you have come forth to strive in My cause and to seek My good pleasure. You show friendship to them in secret, while I am All-Aware of what you conceal and what you reveal. And whosoever of you (Muslims) does that, then indeed he has gone (far) astray from the straight path.} 42. Should they gain the upper hand over you, they would behave to you as enemies, and stretch forth their hands and their tongues against you with evil, and they desire that you should disbelieve.} 43 . Neither your relatives nor your children will benefit you on

the Day of Resurrection . He will judge between you. And Allah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5867]

is the All-Seer of what you do.}

The story of Hatib bin Abi Balta'ah is the reason behind

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5867–5881]

revealing the beginning of this honorable Surah. Hatib was among the Early Emigrants and participated in the battle of Badr. Hatib had children and wealth in Makkah, but he was not from the tribe of Quraysh. Rather, he was an ally of the Thman. When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ decided to conquer Makkah, after its people broke the peace treaty between them, he ordered the Muslims to mobilize their forces to attack Makkah, and then said, «O Allah! Keep our news concealed from them . Hatib wrote a letter and sent it to the people of Makkah, with a woman from the tribe of Quraysh, informing them of the Messenger's intent to attack them. He wanted them to be indebted to him so that they would grant safety to his family in Makkah], Allah the Exalted conveyed this matter to His Messenger ﷺ, because He accepted the Prophet's invocation [to Him to conceal the news of the attack). The Prophet ﷺ sent someone after the woman and retrieved the letter. This story is collected in the Two Sahih. Imam Ahmad recorded that Hasan bin Muhammad bin 'Ali said that 'Abdullah bin Abu Rafi' - or Ubaydullah bin Abu Rafi' - said that he heard 'Ali say, "Allah's Messenger ﷺ sent

584 Tafstr Ibn Kathir me, Zubayr find Al-Miqdad saying, *L<&> l\$J dli £U- <J>jj I Jj Iji&tt “Proceed until you reach Rawdat Khdkhlv , where there is a lady carrying a letter. Take that letterfrom her.» So we proceeded on our way, with our horses galloping, until we reached the Rawdah. There we found the lady and said to her, Take out the letter.’ She said, 1 am not carrying a letter.’ We said, Take out the letter, or else we will take off your clothes.’ So she took it out of her braid, and we brought the letter to Allah’s Messenger j&. The letter was addressed from Hatib bin Abu Balta'ah to some pagans of Makkah, telling them about what Allah’s Messenger jg intended to do. Allah’s Messenger sg said, g?| JLa L* IjS «0 Hatib! What is this? Hatib replied, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Do not make a hasty decision about me. I was a person not belonging to Quraysh, but I was an ally to them. All the Emigrants who were with you have kinsmen (in Makkah) who can protect their families. So I wanted to do them a favor, so they might protect my relatives, as I have no blood relation with them. I did not do this out of disbelief or to renegade from my religion, nor did I do it to choose disbelief after Islam.’ Allah’s Messenger jg| said to his Companions, 4jlt 5Regarding him, he has told you the truth. TJmar said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Allow me to chop off the head of this hypocrite!’ The Prophet jg said, : JUs jX JaI JI ^ii>l <ul kLjjJ Uj i Ijyb <;|t oAJ OjAS. JLU *He attended Badr. What can I tell you, perhaps Allah looked at those who attended Badr and said, “O the people of Badr, do !i] A place, between Makkah and Al-Madinah, which is about twelve miles away from Al-Madinah

585Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (1-3) (Part-28) what you like, for I haveforgiven you.”*” The Group with the exception of Ibn Majah, collected this Hadith using various chains of narration that included Sufyan bin ‘Uyaynah. Al-Bukhari added in his narration in the chapter on the Prophet’s battles, “Then Allah revealed the Surah, i'Zd V p: cj! ats> 40 you who believe! Take not my enemies and your enemies as protectingfriends .. .} ” Al-Bukhari said in another part of his Sahih, ‘Amr (one of the narrators of the Hadith) said, “This Ayah, !P& v p\l: c/M iO you who believe! Take not my enemies and your enemies as protectingfriends was revealed about Hatib, but I do not know if the Ayah was mentioned in the Hadith (or was added as an explanation by one of the narrators).” Al-Bukhari also said that ‘Ali bin Al- Madlni said that Sufyan bin TJyaynah was asked, “Is this why this Ayah, i&d 4s !A£ 40 you who believe! Take not my enemies and your enemies as protecting friends.. was revealed?” Sufyan said, “This is the narration that I collected from ‘Amr, I did not leave a letter out of it. I do not know if anyone else memorized the same words for it.”111 TheCommand to have Enmitytowards the Disbelievers and to abandon supportingThem Allah’s statement, fP Uj jij Pp 'fyPi v p\l: sM Fath Al-Bari 6:166, 7:592, 8:502, Muslim 4:1941, Abu Dawud 3:108, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:198, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra

40 you who believe! Take notMy enemies and your enemies as protecting friends showing affection towards them, while they have disbelieved in what has come to you of the truth,} refers to the idolaters and the disbelievers who are combatants against Allah, His Messenger jg and the believers. It is they whom Allah has decided should be our enemies and should be fought. Allah has forbidden the believers to take them as friends, supporters or companions. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah , A} Crj i 'ji V C/& V-Js^ <0 you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as protecting friends, they are but protectingfriends of each other. And ifany among you takes them (as such), then surely, he is one ofthem.} (5:51) This Ayah contains a stem warning and a sure threat. Allah the Exalted said, M * <£& U3S» '4 *} ip:4 &} 40 you who believe! Take not as protecting friends those zvho take your religion as a mockery andfun from among those who received the Scripture before you, nor from among the

disbelievers; and have Taqwd of Allah if you indeed are true believers.} (5:57) k^ J t/4 kiiiit& M *taii v \}x\$ 40 you who believe! Take notfor protecting friends disbelievers instead of believers. Do you wish to offer Allah a manifest proof against yourselves?} (4:144) and, 4 \$ -ilji J-i** ^3* yji oi 'Qf S-jpi SjLjjiK 4U1 & y^ ijiB *} } 4Let not the believers take the disbelievers as protecting friends instead of the believers, and whoever does that will never be

helped by Allah in any way, except ifyou indeed fear a danger from them. And Allah warns you against Himself (His punishment) (3:28) This is why Allah's Messenger |g accepted Hatib's excuse when he said that he only wanted to have a favor on the Quraysh, because of the property and family members he left behind in Makkah. Allah's statement, ip& iand have driven out the Messenger and yourselves (from your homeland)} follows His encouragement to fight against them and to avoid being their supporters. This is because they expelled the Messenger sg and his Companions on account of their hatred for Tawhid and worshipping Allah alone in sincerity. This is why Allah the Exalted said, 2*4 lAu ibecause you believe in Allah, your Lordly meaning, *your only fault is that you believed in Allah, Lord of all that exists.' Allah the Exalted said in other Ayat. 4And they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, Almighty, Al-Hamid!\$ (85:8) and, /iJf *J -* •/ / *> *4 4^ 'O' (3** ot iThose ivho lutve been expelled from their homes unjustly only because they said: "Our Lord is Allah."> (22:40) Allah said, 'j i 4 Lif>- ilf you have come forth to strive in My cause and to seek My good pleasure.\$ Allah says, *if you are as described here, then do not take the disbelievers as supporters. If you migrated in Jihad for My cause and for seelang My pleasure, then do not take My enemies and your enemies as protecting friends, after they

588 Tafslr Ibn KathTr expelled you from your homes and property in rage against you and rejection ofyour religion.' Allah's statement. <Yom show friendship to them in secret, while I am All-Aware ofwhat you conceal and what you reveal. Allah asks, 'do you do this while I know the secrets of the hearts, the intentions and all apparent things,' i&L (5J \y£> j 6^ Jii iilij 4^ 4And whosoever of you does that, then indeed he has gone astrayfrom the straight path . Should they gain the upper hand over you, they would behave to you as enemies, and stretch forth their hands and their tongues against you with evil,} meaning, 'if they gain the upper hand over you, they would use every type of harm in their disposal to hurt you in words and action,' jl ijlij)1 iand they desire that you should disbelieve.} meaning, 'they are eager that you do not earn any good. Therefore, their enmity to you is outward and inward, ..so how can you become supporters of this type of people?' This also encourages the enmity. Allah's statement, C%p \$\$51%jX£p* J} 4Neither your relatives nor your children will benefit you on the Day ofResurrection . He will judge between you. And Allah is the All-Seer ofwhat you do.} means, "your family relations will not benefit you with Allah if Allah decided to cause harm your way. Your relations will not benefit you if you please them with what angers Allah.' Those who agree with their family being disbelievers in order to please them will have earned loss and failure and their deeds will be rendered invalid. Their relation will not benefit them with Allah, even if their relation was with a Prophet. Imam Ahmad recorded that Anas said that a man said, "O Allah's

589Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (4-6) (Part-28) Messenger! Where is my father?" He said, Jj&J tin the Fire When the man went away, the Prophet jfe called him back and said: j ii&jJ Sit * Verily , my father and your father are in the Fire. 1 11 Muslim and Abu Dawud'21 also collected this Hadith. Uo H illo-

»p1 JL>^> ,iiJ5A £ C? ii^tj ^ cr eg£ if^ ^ ^11 Q\ Qfrf Jx &\$U J# Jjpl Su fgZi jjs vi 43? \;£ uM& Salt ji ^ ^ J>;^ ;^fr fjS it a?4 fcz. £1^ £j of j3 44. Indeed there has been an excellent example for you in Ibrahim and those with him, when they said to their people: "Verily, we are free from you and whatever you worship besides Allah, we have rejected you, and there has started between us and you, hostility and hatred forever until you believe in Allah alone," - except the saying of Ibrahim to his father : "Verily , I will ask forgiveness for you, but I have no power to do anything for you before Allah." "Our Lord! In You we put our trust, and to You we turn in repentance, and to You is the final Return 45. "Our Lord! Make us not a trial for the disbelievers, and forgive us, Our Lord! Verily, You, only You, are the Almighty, the All-Wise."} 46. Certainly, there has been in them an excellent example for you to follow - for those who look forward to (the meeting with) Allah and the Last Day. And whosoever turns away, then verily, Allah is Al-Ghani, Al-Hamid.} 1,1 Ahmad 3:268. 121 Muslim 1 : 191 , Abu Dawud 5:90.

591 Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (4-6) (Part-28) Some of the believers used to invoke Allah for their parents who died as disbelievers, begging Him to forgive them. They did so claiming that Ibrahim used to invoke Allah to forgive his father. Allah the Exalted said in reply, ca u 4j1 % sgpi !&£3 J 0s " ^1 4-ft bj jili 'ft Si fc, toA 5& ,ist /i\$ £B '4l USi; \$i*S 411 is not for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the idolators, even though they be of kin, after it has become clear to them that they are the dwellers of the Fire (because they died in a state of disbelief) . And Ibrahim's request for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he made to him .But when it became clear to him that he was an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily, Ibrahim was Awwah ll] and was forbearing.} (9:1 13-1 14) Allah said here, hAy. ffyi ->! ?*" i X) jui } ilndeed there has been an excellent example for you in Ibrahim and those with him, when they said to their people: "Verily, we are free from you.. ."} until, ot tiipl t*j el! o/fXS)) 4... except the saying of Ibrahim to his father: "Verily, I will ask forgiveness for you, but I have no power to do anything for you before Allah."} meaning, You cannot follow Ibrahim's example as proof in the case mentioned here, as being allowed to ask Allah to forgive those who died on Shirk.' This is the saying of Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak and several others.121 Allah the Exalted said that Ibrahim and his companions, who parted with their people and disowned their way, said afterwards, while invoking Allah in humility and submission, See the Tafsir of Surat At-Tawbah (9 : 1 14) At-Tabari 23:318.

592 Tahir Ibn Kathir i (A iili [\$} iOur Lord! In You we put our trust, and to You we turn in repentance, and to You is the final Return.} meaning, "we trust in You for all matters, we surrender all of our affairs to You, and to You is the final Return in the Hereafter," i[UM £2*: £4 V %} iOur Lord! Make us not a trial for the disbelievers,} Mujahid said, "It means, "Do not punish us by their hands, nor with a punishment from You.' Or they will say, Had these people been following the truth, the torment would not have struck them'. "I 1 * Ad-Dahhak said something similar. Qatadah said, "Do not give the disbelievers victory over us, thus subjecting us to trials by their hands. Surely, if You do so, they would then think that they were given victory over us because they are on the truth." This is the meaning that Ibn Jarir preferred. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas: "Do not give them dominance over us, lest we suffer trials by their hands." Allah's statement, 4J&1 yj\34% u iand forgive us, Our Lord! Verily, You, only You, are the Almighty, the All-Wise.} means, 'cover our mistakes from being exposed to other than You, and forgive us for what (sin) is between us and You.' 3Mt} iVerily, You, only You, are the Almighty,} 'and those who seek refuge in Your majesty are never dealt with unjustly,' i.i&t ithe All-

Wise.} ‘in Your statements, actions, legislation and decrees.’ Allah the Exalted said, iUsf fj if &A^y&EX hj> iCertainly, there has been in them an excellent example for you m Aj-Tabari 23:319.

to follow - for those who look forward to (the meeting with) Allah and the Last Day.} asserting what He has said before with the exemption mentioned, i.e., the good example that Allah mentioned before, i'Ji'y £55# of ^/or those who look forward to Allah and the Last Day.} thus encouraging the believers who believe in Allah and the Return to Him. Allah said, <&. iAnd whosoever turns away} meaning, from what Allah has ordained, ft. Sut iverily, Allah is Al-Ghani, Al-Hamid.} Allah said in another Ayah, itff Xf- Lj'jV' ^ you disbelieve, you and all on the earth together, then verily! Allah is Ghani, Hamid.} (14:8) ‘Ali bin Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “iGhani} is the One Who is perfectly rich.” That is Allah. This is Allah’s attribute that He alone is worthy of being described by; surely, He has no equal, none like unto Him. All praise is due to Allah, the One, the Irresistible. iij.} }Hamid} means, the praiseworthy, in all His statements and actions, there is no (true) God except Him alone. "J jy* 1\$ jm itjl ffft. o>Ji iff) o' lr*} k rfrbU; £ fei« Jg££ C04&ZJ <£fa££ l£fk) 'ff.i Jt jXXA) 4 4.3 if t£>\ iif fj ffj o' & }7. Perhaps Allah will make friendship between you and those

594 Tafclr Ibn Kathir whom you hold as enemies. And Allah has power (over all things), and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 48. Allah does not forbid you to deal justly and kindly with those who fought not against you on account of religion nor drove you out of your homes. Verily, Allah loves those who deal with equity.} 49. It is only as regards those who fought against you on account of religion, and have driven you out of your homes, and helped to drive you out, that Allah forbids you to befriend them. And whosoever will befriend them, then such are the wrongdoers.} Perhaps Allah will make a Friendship between You and Those, whom You hold as Enemies Allah said to His faithful servants, after ordering them to be enemies with the disbelievers, 4'b* (44 3 iif tfr*} 4Perhaps Allah will make friendship between you and those, whom you hold as enemies.} meaning affection after animosity, tenderness after coldness and coming together after parting from each other, 4ja* "dj} 4And Allah has power (over all things),} Allah is able to gather opposites and bring together hearts, after feeling hostility and hardness. In this case, the hearts will come together in agreement, just as Allah said when He mentioned His favor on the Ansar, ;> if \g%} 4And remember Allah's favor on you, for you were enemies one to another but He joined your hearts together, so that, by His grace, you became brethren and were on the brink of a pit of Fire, and He saved you from it.} (3:103) Also the Prophet jg| said to them,

595 Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (7-9) (Part-28) tDid 1 not find you misguided, and Allah guided you through me; and divided, and Allah united [your hearts] through me? iM Allah the Exalted said, ^ jn4< ^ 6^5=«Jj -Lfjjii 'Clift 4He if is Who has supported you with His help and with the believers. And He has united their hearts. If you had spent all that is in the earth, you could not have united their hearts, but Allah has united them. Certainly He is Almighty, All-Wise.} (8:62,63) Ana ijk it Ai b'l J *^ ^ * * t * s L)j£j ol <.u *Love your loved one moderately, because one day, he might become your enemy. Hate your hated one moderately, because one day, he might become your loved one 42i Allah’s statement, jj% iAnd Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} means, Allah forgives the disbelief of the disbelievers if they repent from it, returned to their Lord and surrendered to Him in Islam. Surely, He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most-Merciful to those who repent to Him from their sins, no matter what type of the sin

it is. The Permissibility of being Kind to Disbelievers who do not fight against the Religion And Allah's statement; ife> & J8* i; 4 f8#yS it® -ft iAllah does not forbid you with those who fought not against * Fath Al-Bari 7 :644 . TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 : 133 .

until the end of the Ayah. Allah's Messenger jg ordered Asma' to accept her mother's gifts and to let her enter her house. ”* 1 Allah's statement, 4.Allah loves those who deal with equity.) was duly explained in

the Tafsir of Surat Al-HujuratJ2

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5881]

' We also mentioned the authentic Hadith, Ji brf- It* ji if 5'^3 ^3 p-fcj^3 <iThe just, who are fair in their decisions, families and those under their authority, will be on podiums made of light, to the right of the ThroneJl3]

The Prohibition of being Kind towards Combatant

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5881–5895]

Disbelievers Allah's statement, if f£> o; 4 'fj& oji ^ ii' ilt is only as regards those who fought against you on account of religion, and have driven you out of your homes, and helped to drive you out that Allah forbids you to befriend them.) (60:9) means, 'Allah forbids you from being kind and befriending with the disbelievers who are openly hostile to you, those who fought against you, expelled you and helped to expel you. Allah the Exalted forbids you from being their friends and orders you to be their enemy.' Then Allah stresses His threat against being friends with them, by saying, Ahmad 4 :4 . There is a deficiency in its chain , but its meaning is supported by the earlier narration . And Dibab is a dish made with dates and clarified butter. See volume nine , the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hujurat (49 :9) Muslim 3:1458.

ff^ — wssm ^ | ^ •«S'f'--tfM,t{-''''''^i-'''''' -'-1- • fcVi?1-! * r <JrJ r>i ' 4Ana whosoever will befriend them, then such are the wrongdoers. As He said; 14S v J£f. ^it uj?*i *y^ i»r*“ sa^1> ^>» rrJ 5\$ (& r^A. j3Bf jj45 ^ ;»>'>-t'» -t'.t-c-". >•. ' 'hi*"" i<~ ^»-jjja£-a^jj>_Jiaii\j uU)lu^J^Ab_ iO you who believe! Take not the Jews and the Christians as protecting friends, they are but protecting friends of each other. And if any among you takes them (as protecting friends), then surely, he is one of them. Verily, Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers (5 :51) 4 l&hj ft&&U& 4 p: '\$\$0 'Sr % fa tl U& £ % ? 4X & * ^3f Ji * *££ t -all Z j\$3\^ %UJ& j££ jto ji & ?*s ojj® p iif;Ja *£2 \$t \$L \$\$ fa <01>u• •* ft vM&\% fa t JL; <£e# \$3 -sa 420. O you who believe! When believing women come to you as emigrants, examine them ; Allah knows best as to their faith, then if you ascertain that they are true believers, send them not back to the disbelievers. They are not lawful for the disbelievers nor are the disbelievers lawful for them. But give them (disbelievers) that which they have spent (on their dowry). And

599Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (10-11) (Part-28) there will be no sin on you to marry them if you have paid their due to them. Likewise do not keep the disbelieving women, and ask for that which you have spent (on their dowry) and let them (the disbelievers) ask for that which they have spent. That is the

judgement of Allah, He judges between you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} ill. And if any of your wives have gone from you to the disbelievers then you succeed over them (gain victory); then pay those whose wives have gone, the equivalent of what they had spent. And have Taqwa of Allah, the One in Whom you are believers .} After Al-Hudaybiyyah, Emigrant Muslim Women may not be returned to the Disbelievers In Surat Al-Fathj 1] we related the story of the treaty at Al- Hudaybiyyah that was conducted between the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and the disbelievers of Quraysh. In that treaty, there were these words, “Everyman (in another narration, every person) who reverts from our side to your side, should be returned to us, even if he is a follower of your religion.” This was said by Tirmidhi, Ad-Dahhak, ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd, Az-Zuhri, Muqatil bin Hayyan and As-Suddi. So according to this narration, this Ayah specifies and explains the Sunnah. And this is the best case of understanding. Yet according to another view of some of the Salaf, it abrogates it. Allah the Exalted and Most High ordered His faithful servants to test the faith of women who emigrate to them. When they are sure that they are faithful, they should not send them back to the disbelievers, for the disbelievers are not allowed for them and they are not allowed for the disbelievers. In the biography of ‘Abdullah bin Abi Ahmad bin Jahsh in Al- Musnad Al-Kabir, we also mentioned that ‘Abdullah bin Abi Ahmad said, “Umm Kulthum bint ‘Uqbah bin Abi Mu'ayt emigrated and her brothers, ‘Umarah and Al-Walid, went after her. They came to Allah’s Messenger ﷺ and talked to him about Umm Kulthum and asked that she be returned to them. See the beginning of Surat Al-Fath (48) in volume nine.

601 Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (10-11) (Part-28) Abu Al-‘As bin Ar-Rabi* was married to Zaynab, the Prophet’s daughter. She was a Muslim, while Abu Al-‘As was still an idolator like his people. When he was captured during the battle of Badr, his wife, Zaynab, sent his ransom, a necklace that belonged to the Prophet’s first wife Khadijah. The Prophet ﷺ became very emotional when he saw the necklace and said to the Companions, *“If you decide to set free the prisoner who belongs to her, then do so.”* They did, and Allah’s Messenger ﷺ set him free. His ransom was that he send his wife to Allah’s Messenger ﷺ. Abu Al-‘As fulfilled his promise and sent Zaynab to Allah’s Messenger ﷺ along with Zayd bin Harithah.’ Zaynab remained in Al-Madinah after the battle of Badr, which took place in the second year of Hijrah, until her husband Abu Al-‘As bin Ar-Rabi* embraced Islam in the eighth year after the Hijrah. She returned to their marriage without renewing the dowry. Allah’s statement, *“But give them that which they have spent.”* meaning, the husbands of the emigrant women who came from the idolaters, return the dowry that they gave to their wives. This was said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Az- Zuhri and several others.’³¹ Allah’s statement, *“And there will be no sin on you to marry them if you have paid their due to them.”* means, when you wish to marry them, then give them their ¹¹¹ Abu Dawud 3 :140. ² What is correct is that it was the sixth year before Al-Hudaybiyyah before this Ayah was revealed At-Jabari 23 :328, 329.

602 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir dowry. That is, marry them under the condition that their ‘Iddah (waiting period) is finished and they have a legal guardian for their marriage etc. Allah said, *“Likewise do not keep disbelieving women, thus forbidding His faithful servants from marrying idolator women or remaining married to them.”* In the Sahih, it is recorded that Al-Miswar and Marwan bin Al-Hakam said that after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ conducted the treaty with the Quraysh idolators at Al-Hudaybiyyah, some Muslim women emigrated to him and Allah the Exalted sent down this Ayah about them, *“O you who believe! When believing women come to you as emigrants until, if you like, you may give them what they have spent.”* ^{#0 40} you who believe! When believing women come to you as emigrants^ until, if you like, you may give them what they have spent.

do not keep disbelieving women, Then Umar bin Al-Khattab divorced two of his wives, who were idolatresses, and one of them got married to Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan, while the other got married to Safwan bin Umayyah. Ibn Thawr narrated that Ma'mar said that Az-Zuhri said, "This Ayah was revealed to Allah's Messenger while he was in the area of Al-Hudaybiyyah, after making peace. He agreed that whoever comes from the Quraysh to his side, will be returned to Makkah. When some women came, this Ayah was revealed. Allah commanded that the dowry that was paid to these women be returned to their husbands. Allah also ordered that if some Muslim women revert to the side of the idolators, the idolators should return their dowry to their Muslim husbands. Allah said, ijP' iK4 iLikewise do not keep disbelieving women^."121 111 FathAl-B&ri 5:391. At-Jabari 23 :329 . See the section about narrations at the beginning of the book

Allah's statement, <1\$ £\$\$ -uLl £ iand ask for that which you have spent and let them ask for that which they have spent. means, ask them for what you have paid to your wives who reverted to the side of the idolaters, and they are entitled to get back the dowry that they gave their wives who emigrated to the Muslims. Allah's statement, pi. S< JB-p» iThat is the judgement of Allah, He judges between you means, this judgement about the treaty and excluding women from its clauses, is a decision that Allah made for His creatures, iAnd Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise .^ meaning, He knows what benefits His servants and is the Most Wise about that. Allah the Exalted said, £ js&& <<4 ijepa j£\$ % iAnd if any of your wives have gone from you to the disbelievers - then you succeeded (gained victory) over them; then pay those whose wives have gone, the equivalent of what they had spent.) Mujahid and Qatadah explained this Ayah, by saying, "This is about the disbelievers who did not have a treaty of peace. If a woman flees to the disbelievers and they do not give back what that her husband spent on her, then if a woman comes to them (the Muslims) they are not to return to her husband anything until they pay the Muslim whose wife went to them the equivalent of what he spent. ",1 > Ibn Jarir recorded that Az-Zuhri said, "The believers abided by Allah's decree and paid what they owed the idolaters to compensate for the dowry the idolaters gave to the women m At-Tabari 23:338.

Jr lilSIi&S oo \ jto^V^_>driy^f [>t*IL ^Sa(who emigrated). ,r" ^ *(>4^ 4 & &dm % Osjas*'^}\^p \r>M%0 However, the idolators refused to accept Allah's judgement for what they owed the Muslims. Allah said to the faithful believers, ii £& s# \$5f j& pa jfcx \$S i£a c jl;^ /,a':4/ >•> >< 'H^ 4And if any of your wives have gone from you to the disbelievers - then you succeeded (gained victory) over them ; then pay those whose wives have gone, the equivalent of what they had spent. And have Taqwa of Allah, the One in Whom your are believers.} Therefore, if a Muslim woman reverts to the idolators, the believers should give back the dowry her Muslim husband paid her, from whatever money is left with them from the dowry of women who migrated to the Muslims. They were supposed to return this wealth to the idolator husbands of these emigrant women. If they still have anything they owed the idolators, then they should return it to them." cs&%^4%& it ^XA -i J£ iijdt M- q\$ it ii it#^tj si*e [11 At-Tabari 23 :337

605 Surah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (12) (Part-28) 412. O Prophet! When the believing women come to you pledging to you that they will not associate anything with Allah, and that they will not steal, and tlm they will not commit Zina, and that they will not kill their children, and that they will not utter slander, fabricating from between their hands and their feet, and that they will not disobey you in Ma'ruf (good),

then accept their pledge, and ask Allah to forgive them. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Matters the Women pledged to Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah the wife of the Prophet jg said, “Allah’s Messenger jg used to examine women who migrated to his side according to this Ayah, 4&1LC Jk’C tij 40 Prophet! When believing women come to you pledging to you ...> until, 4 Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.}” ‘Urwah said, “ A’ishah said, When any believing woman agreed to these conditions, Allah’s Messenger gg would say to her, have accepted your pledge . but, by Allah, he never touched the hand of any women at all while taking the pledge from them. He only took their pledge of allegiance by saying, «/ have accepted your pledge.*’ This is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Imam Ahmad recorded that Umaymah bint Ruqayqah said, “I came to Allah’s Messenger jg with some women to give him our pledge and he took the pledge from us that is mentioned in the Qur’an, that we associate none with Allah, etc; as in the Ayah. Then he said, m Fath Al-Bari 8 :504

UJ» aAs much as you can bear to implements We said, ‘Surely, Allah and His Messenger are more merciful with us than we are with ourselves.’ We then said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger, should you not shake hands with us?’ He said, 55U J’jiS Uij ifllll! £iuf V J\> “I do not shake hands with women, for my statement to one woman is as sufficient as my statement to a hundred womens’ This Hadith has an authentic chain of narration; At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah collected it.’ Al-Bukhari also recorded that Umm ‘Atiyah said, “The Messenger of Allah took our pledge and recited to us the Ayah, i...that they will not associate anything with Allah,} and forbade us to wail for the dead. Thereupon, a lady withdrew her hand saying, ‘But such and such lady shared with me in lamenting (over one of my relatives), so I must reward hers.’ The Prophet ^ did not object to that, so she went there and returned to the Prophet and he accepted her pledge of allegiance.”131 Muslim also collected this Hadith. Imam Ahmad recorded that Tjbadah bin As-Samit said, “While we were with the Prophet jg, he said, \jkjij y’j ‘jj tljiylj Nj i U—i jilt \jSyZ3 f- «Pledge to me in that you will not associate any with Allah, nor steal, nor commit Zina, nor kill your childrens Then he recited the Ayah that begins; Ahmad 6:367. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5:220 and An-Nasal 7:149, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :488 and Ibn Majah 2 :959 131 Path Al-Bari 8 :506 Muslim 2 : 646

607Siirah 60. Al-Mumtahanah (12) (Part-28) iSS.p\ iivheti the believing women come to you ...> and took the pledge of allegiance from the women. He sg then added, 3** 4-i.A '~4 iiJi ^ ,143 ‘j** 1 ^ •>»-£ i ijj 14“ jlj id it! jj i dll Jj Jj dip ill (Li iljjJ OU»i Jj iij «4JLp ;Li “Those among you who fulfill this pledge, will receive their reward from Allah. Tlwse who deviate from any of it and receive the legal punishment (in this life), the punishment will be expiation for that sin. Whoever deviates from any of it and Allah screens him, then it is up to Allah to punish orforgive if He wills ,»[11 The Two Sahihs recorded this Hadith)2 ^ Allah’s statement, 4&LC iifc lit 40 Prophet! When the believing women come to you pledging to you means, ‘if any woman comes to you to give you the pledge and she accepts these conditions, then accept the pledge from her,’ i’M%eA&& y J ithat they will not associate anything with Allah, that they will not steal,> meaning, the property of other people. In the case where a husband is not fulfilling his duty of spending on his wife, then she is allowed to use a part of his wealth, what is reasonable, to spend on herself. This is the case regardless of whether the husband knows about his wife’s actions or not, because of the Hadith in which Hind bint Utbah said, “O Allah’s Messenger! Abu Sufyan is a miser! He does not give me sufficient money for the living expense of our family and myself. Am I allowed *** Ahmad 5 :314. Fath Al-Bari 8 :506 and Muslim 3 : 1333

608 Tafstr Ibt Kathir to secretly take from his money without his knowledge?” Allah’s Messenger said to her, dUSL L. i jjiJLi L» aJ IJa ^Jo-- «Yom may takefrom what is reasonable and appropriate for you and your children^ This Hadith was recorded in the two Sahihs. Allah’s statement, 4they will not commit Zina,} is similar to His other statement. i iif i£ii Slj> 4And come not near to Az-Zind. Verily, it is a Faliishah (immoral act) and an evil way.} (17:32) A Hadith collected from Samurah mentions that for the adulterers and fornicators there is a painful torment in the fire of HellJ21 Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “Fatimah bint TJtbah came to give her pledge to Allah’s Messenger who took the pledge from her, 4.U&.% c)-A ^& 4that they will not associate anything with Allah, they will not steal, that they will notcommit Zina (fornication and adultery),} Fatimah bashfully placed her hand on her head in shyness. The Prophet liked what she did. ‘A’ishah said, ‘O woman! Accept the pledge, because by Allah, we all gave the pledge to the same.’ She said, *Yes then,’ and she gave her pledge to the same things mentioned in the Ayah.’ ”*3’ Allah’s statement, 4*21 -ij} 4that they will not kill their children,} includes killing children after they are bom. The people of Jahiliyyah used to kill their children because they feared poverty. The Ayah includes killing 111 Fath Al-Bari 13 :183 and Muslim 3 :1338 Ahmad 5 : 9 Ahmad 6:151.

the fetus, just as some ignorant women do for various evil reasons. Allah’s statement. iand that they will not utter slander, fabricating from between their hands and theirfeet,) Ibn ‘Abbas said, “It means that they not to attribute to their husbands other than their legitimate children.” Muqatil said similarly. Allah’s statement, iand that they will not disobey you in hAa’riif (good,) means, that they will obey you when you order them to do good and forbid them from evil.’ Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said about Allah’s statement, iand that they will not disobey you in any Ma’riif (good,) “This was one of the conditions which Allah imposed on the women.”*2 * MaymUn bin Mihran said, “Allah did not order obedience to His Prophet for other than Ma’ruf, and Ma’ruf is itself obedience.”*3 * Ibn Zayd said, “Allah commanded that His Messenger, the best of His creation, be obeyed in that which is Ma’ruf”W Ibn Jarir recorded that Umm ‘Atiyah Al-Ansariyah said, “Among the conditions included in our pledge to Allah’s Messenger to good was not to wail. A woman said, ‘So-and-so family brought comfort to me (by wailing over my dead relative), so I will first pay them back.’ So she went and paid them back in the same (wailed for their dead), and then came and gave her pledge. Only she and Umm Sulaym bint Milhan, the mother of Anas bin Malik, did so.”*5 ' Al-Bukhari collected [1 * At-Tabari 23:340. ' FathAl-Bari 8 :506 * Al-Qurtubi 18:73. At-Tabari 23:345. * At-Tabari 23:346.

they do not believe in Resurrection or being brought back to life. Therefore, they have no hope that they will meet them again, according to their creed. Secondly, just as the disbelievers who are buried in graves have lost hope in receiving any kind of goodness (i.e., after seeing the punishment and knowing that Resurrection is true). Al-A’mash reported from Abu Ad-Duha from Masruq that Ibn Mas'ud said, J*\ £ j&S CS> ijust as the disbelievers have despaired of those (buried) in graves.} “Just as the disbeliever despairs when he dies and realizes and knows his (evil) recompense.” This is the saying of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Muqatil, Ibn Zayd, Al-Kalbi and Mansur;’ Ibn Jarir preferred this explanation.’2 '

Surah 61: As-Saff

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5896]

Opening 612 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Tafslrof SuratAs-Saff (Chapter - 61)

Which was revealed inAl-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5896–5912]

The Virtues of SuratAs-Saff Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Salam said, “We asked, ‘Who among us should go to the Messenger jg and ask him about the dearest actions to Allah?’ None among us volunteered. The Messenger jg sent a man to us and that man gathered us and recited this Surah, Surat As-Saff, in its entirety.’ ”1 ' In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. (*l 1v-*** J?yii 4 Uj 4 £ £^} % k 1 U * C^ so: ^ 4 44 41- Whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth glorifies Allah. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise. 42 . O you who believe! Why do you say that which you do not do?} 43. Most hateful it is with Allah that you say that which you do not do.} 44. Verily, Allah loves tlwse whofight in His cause in rows as ifthey were a solid structure.} ChastisingThose Who say what They do not do We mentioned in many a places before the meaning of Allah’s statement, m Ahmad 5 :452

Siirali 61 . As-Saff (1-4) (Part-28) 613 cr> iWhatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth glorifies Allah. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise Therefore, we do not need to repeat its meaning hereJ Allah’s statement, 40 you toho believe! Why do you say that which you do not do?\$ This refutes those who neglect to fulfill their promises. This honorable Ayah supports the view that several scholars of the Salaf held, that it is necessary to fulfill the promise, regardless of whether the promise includes some type of wealth for the person receiving the promise or otherwise. They also argue from the Sunnah, with the Hadith recorded in the Two Sahihs in which Allah’s Messenger gg said, lilj t jS «. iL>- 1 At-j lil : “There are three signs for a hypocrite: when he promises, he breaks his promise; when speaks, he lies; and when he is entrusted, he betrays . And in another Hadith in the Sahih, -ci Oj IS- j A- i CJtf 0*5 1 UaJl^ UilL* jl5 fj “There are four characteristics which if one has all of them, he is the pure hypocrite, and if anyone has any of them, he has a characteristic ofhypocrisy, until he abandons if.»|31 So he mentioned breaking the promise among these four characteristics. We mentioned the meaning of these two ffadiths in the beginning of the explanation of Sahih Al- Bukh&ri, and to Allah is the praise and the thanks. Therefore AllSh implied this meaning, when He continued His "" See volume nine , the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hadid (57 : 1) I2 ' Fath. Al-Bari 1:111 and Muslim 1 :78 131 Fath Al-Bari 1:111.

614 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr admonishment by saying, 'Most hateful it is with Allah that you say that which you do not do.' Imam Ahmad and Abu Dawud recorded that 'Abdullah bin 'Amir bin Rabl'ah said, "Allah's Messenger came to us while I was a young boy, and I went out to play. My mother said, 'O 'Abdullah! Come, I want to give you something.' Allah's Messenger said to her, "What did you want to give him?" She said, 'Dates.' He said, 'If you had not given them to him, it would have been written as a lie in your record.' Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "The faithful believers said, 'If we only knew the dearest good actions to Allah, we would perform them.' Thus, Allah told them about the dearest actions to Him saying, 'Verily, Allah loves those who fight in His cause in rows.' Allah stated what He likes, and they were tested on the day of Uhud. However, they retreated and fled, leaving the Prophet behind. It was about their case that Allah revealed this Ayah: 'O you who believe! Why do you say that which you do not do?' Allah says here, 'The dearest of you to Me, is he who fights in My cause.' Some said that it was revealed about the gravity of fighting in battle, when one says that he fought and endured the battle." Ahmad 3 :447 and Abu Dawud 5 :265. [2] Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :146

625 Surah 61 . As-Saff (5-6) (Part-28) battle, even though he did not do so. Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said that this Ayah was sent down to admonish some people who used to say that they killed, fought, stabbed, and did such and such during battle, even though they did not do any of it. Said bin Jubayr said about Allah's statement, 'Verily, Allah loves those who fight in His cause in rows (ranks)' "Before Allah's Messenger began the battle against the enemy, he liked to line up his forces in rows; in this Surah, Allah teaches the believers to do the same." He also said that Allah's statement, 'as if they were a solid structure.' means, its parts are firmly connected to each other; in rows for battle. Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "Firmly connected to each other." Ibn 'Abbas commented on the meaning of the Ayah, let: 'as if they were a solid structure.' by saying, "They are like a firm structure that does not move, because its parts are cemented to each other." 2 ' -ff ff 'if) J'i fs fyi' iJ+r. ^ yil (j* iEx IJ ^ Jj« 4i&&i / * 1 »- Mi; *- \ »*: \ 'fy? Ujj4 !yli pA*U. LJ* -L/"» jAr- ' 'S-fi 0} !A^j }5. And when Musa said to his people: "O my people! Why do you annoy me while you know certainly that I am the Messenger of Allah to you? So, when they turned away (from the path of Allah), Allah turned their hearts away (from the right path). And Allah guides not the people who are 111 Al-Qurtubi 18:81. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :147

616 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr rebellious.} 46. And (remember) when 'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Children of Israel! I am the Messenger of Allah unto you, confirming the Tawrah [which came] before me, and giving glad tidings of a Messenger to come after me, whose name shall be Ahmad. "But when he came to them with clear proofs, they said: "This is plain magic."} Musa admonishes His People for annoying Him Allah states that His servant and Messenger Musa, son of Imran, to whom Allah spoke directly, said to his people, "Why do you annoy me while you know certainly that I am the Messenger of Allah to you?" meaning, "why do you annoy me even though you know my truth regarding the Message that I brought you?" This brings consolation for Allah's Messenger for what the disbelievers among his people and others did to him. And it orders him to be patient. This is why he once said, 'I am patient' Jijf iij 4)1 «May Allah have mercy with Musa: he was annoyed more than this, yet he was patient. By it believers are prohibited from harming or bothering the Prophet in any way or form. As Allah the Exalted said, 'O you who believe! Be not like those who annoyed Musa, but

Allah cleared him of that which they alleged, and he was honorable before Allah.} (33 :69) And His saying: 4[^J* ^ £&} 4So, when they turned away, Allah turned their hearts away.}, m Fath Al-Bari 7 : 652

617Surah 61 . As-Saff (5-6) (Part-28) means, when the Jews turned away from following the guidance, even though they knew it, Allah turned their hearts away from the guidance. Instead, Allah placed doubts, suspicion and failure in their hearts, just as He said, Jjt ** IJ-tjt ') IT}<S P4 iAnd We shall turn their hearts and vision away, as they refused to believe therein for the first time, and we shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly.} And His saying; Jj* U -A* jjij ^3 OjJ b Jju Si Jj jijLiJ Vi} iAnd whoever contradicts and opposes the Messenger after the right path has been shown clearly to him, and follows other than the believers' way, We shall keep him in the path he has chosen, and enter him in Hell, what an evil destination it is!} (4:115), and, Similarly Allah said; pi)' <s£_ ^i} iAnd Allah guides not the people who are rebellious.} (9:24) TheGoodNews of'IsaaboutOurProphet^and thatHis Name isAhmad Allah said; v, i-£Ji lie* Q lijrfi ^ Ji«5“! if'A Wf t S'V*'-.-it ^ l3u fts c iAnd when 'Isa, son of Maryam, said: "O Children of Israel! I am the Messenger of Allah unto you, confirming the Tawrah before me, and giving glad tidings of a Messenger to come after me, whose name shall be Ahmad."} Isa said, "The Tawrah conveyed the glad tidings of my coming, and my coming confirms the truth of the Tawrah. I convey the glad tidings of the Prophet who will come after me. He is the unlettered, Makkan, Arab Prophet and Messenger, Ahmad."

619Surah 61 . As-Saff (5-6) (Part-28) 'i i'll ' OjU-JJ o «/ axis written with Allah as the Last and Final of the Prophet, even when Adam was still clay. I will tell of the first good news announcing my advent, the (result of the) invocation to Allah made from my father Ibrahim, the good news 'Isa conveyed, and the dream that my mother saw . The mothers of all Prophets see similar dreams."^ Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Umamah said, "I said, 'O Allah's Messenger! What was the first good news of your coming?' He said, ifdJi «77ie (result of the) invocation to Allah made from my father Ibrahim and the good news 'Isa conveyed. My mother saw a light emanating from her that filled the palaces of Ash-Sham in a dream"121 Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mastad said that the Messenger of Allah jg sent eighty men, including 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Ja'far bin Abi Talib, 'Abdullah bin Tjrfutah, 'Uthman bin Maz'un, Abu Musa, and others, to An-Najashi. The Quraysh sent 'Amr bin Al-'As and TJmarah bin Al-Walid with a gift for An-Najashi. When they, 'Amr and 'Umarah, came to An-Najashi, they prostrated before him and stood to his right and left. 'Amr and TJmarah said, "Some of our cousins migrated to your land; they have abandoned us and our religion." An-Najashi said, "Where are they?" They said, "They are in your land, so send for them," so An-Najashi summoned the Muslims. Ja'far said to the Muslims, "I will be your speaker today." So, the Muslims followed Ja'far and when he entered on the king he did not 111 Ahmad 4:127. Ahmad 5 :262 . There are some deficiencies in some of these narrations . Many scholars consider them to support each other as does the author

prostrate after greeting him. They said to Ja'far, "Why do you not prostrate before the king?" Ja'far said, "We only prostrate for Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored." They said, "Why?" He said, "Allah has sent a Messenger to us from Him, who ordered us not to prostrate to anyone except Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. He also ordered to perform prayer and give charity." 'Amr bin Al-'As said, "They contradict your creed about Isa, son of Maryam." The king asked, "What do you say about Isa

and his mother Maiyam?" Ja'far said, "We only say what Allah said about him, that he is Allah's Word¹¹¹, a soul created by Allah and sent down to the honorable virgin who was not touched by a man nor bearing children before." An-Najashi lifted a straw of wood and said, "O Ethiopians, monks and priests! By Allah, what they say about Isa is no more than what we say about him, not even a difference that equals this straw. You are welcomed among us, and greetings to him who sent you. I bear witness that he is Allah's Messenger whom we read about in the Injil. He is the Prophet who Isa, son of Maryam, foretold the good news about his advent. Live wherever you wish. By Allah, had I not been entrusted with the responsibilities of kingship, I would have gone to him, so that I could be honored by carrying his slippers and his water for ablution." The king ordered that the gifts of the idolators be returned to them. 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud soon returned and later on participated in the battle of Badr. He said that when the Prophet received the news that An-Najashi died, he invoked Allah to forgive him.¹² Allah said, iBut when he came to them with clear proofs, they said: "This is plain magic."} this refers to Ahmad, who was anticipated, in accordance with the early Scriptures and early generations, according to Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Jarir. When the Prophet appeared bringing clear signs, the disbelievers and rejecters said, Meaning, that Allah said, "Be" and he was. * Ahmad 1 :46 1

ild%&} iThis is plain magic^ ,4r"J S-*y cfjff j* »j^=> jlj '-V 1 '(? *@!-> rt^A :/ ji; > £\$\$& zty 47. And who does more wrong than the one who invents a lie against Allah, while he is being invited to Islam? And Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers. 48. They intend to put out the Light of Allah with their mouths. But Allah will bring His Light to perfection even though the disbelievers hate (it).} 49. He it is Who has sent His Messenger with guidance and the religion of truth to make it victorious over all religions even though idolators hate (it).} The Most Unjust among all People Allah said. i J| &£% wiof if '\$ 4And who does more wrong titan the one who invents a lie against Allah, while he is being invited to Islam?} meaning, none is more unjust than he who lies about Allah and calls upon rivals and associates partners with Him, even while he is being invited to Tawhid and sincerely worshipping Him. This is why Allah said, 4 f>iif v *^j} 4And Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.} Allah said, s''' £ i&£l 4They intend to put out the Light ofAllah with their mouths.} indicating that the disbelievers will try to contradict the truth with falsehood. Their attempts are similar to one's attempt to extinguish the sun with his mouth, which is impossible.

623Surah 61 . As-Saff(10-13) (Part-28 and your lives, that will be betterfor you, ifyou but know!} 412. (If you do so) He will forgive you your sins, and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow, and pleasant dioellings in 'Adn (Eternal) Paradise; that is indeed the great success.} 413. And also (He will give you) another (blessing) which you love, helpfrom Allah and a near victory. And give glad tidings to the believers.} The Trade that savesOne from the Painful Torment We mentioned a HacLith from 'Abdullah bin Salam in that the Companions wanted to ask the Prophet of Allah jg about the best actions with Allah the Exalted and Most Honored, so they could practice them. Allah the Exalted sent down this Surah, including this Ayah, 4 it }fi&0> \$£> <0 you who believe! Shall I guide you to a trade that will save you from a painful torment?} Allah then explained this great trade that will never fail, the trade that will earn one what he wishes and saves him from what he dislikes. Allah the Exalted said, 4That you believe in Allah and His Messenger, and tluit you strive hard andfight in the cause ofAllah with your wealth and your lives, that will be betterfor you, ifyou but know!} this is better than the trade of this life and striving hard for it and amassing it. Allah the Exalted said, 4He will forgive you your

sins,} meaning, 'if you fulfill what I commanded you and guided you to, then I will forgive your sins and admit you into the Gardens of Paradise. In them, you will have exalted residences and high positions.' This is why Allah the Exalted said, *And admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow, and*

624 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr pleasant dwellings in 'Adn (Eternal) Paradise; that is indeed the great success. Allah said, *And also another (blessing) which you love,* meaning, I will grant you more favors that you like,' *Xa ' Jf *.;V "rt/ c*j J^T ihelpfrom Allah and a near victory .)* meaning, ifyou fight in Allah's cause and support His religion, He will grant you victory. Allah the Exalted said, *V' .y.r- 40 you who believe! Ifyou help (in the cause of) Allah, He will help you, and make yourfootholdfirm.)* (47:7), and, *4t£ iVerily, Allah will help those who help His (cause). Trtdy, Allah is All Strong, All-Wise.)* (22:40) Allah's statement, *and a near victory.)* means, it will come sooner, and this is the increased favor that is earned in this life and continues, becoming the delight of the Hereafter. It is for those who obey Allah and His Messenger and support Allah and His religion. Allah said; *And give glad tidings to the believers.) JL ftjLait Jlj CT jUit \jfo \JSi. <1^ Crt Aj|U» *ii\ XJ cfo Jli \L'& "" ' ' - 414. O you who believe! Be you helpers (in the cause) ofAllah as said 'Isa, son ofMaryam, to the HawarTyym (the disciples): "Who are my helpers (in the cause) ofAllah?" The Hawariyyun*

625Surah 61 . As-Saff (14) (Part-28) said: "We are Allah's helpers" (i.e., we will strive in His cause!). Then a group of the Children of Israel believed and a group disbelieved. So, We gave power to those who believed against their enemies, and they became the victorious (uppermost)> Muslims are always the Natural Supporters ofIslam Allah the Exalted orders His faithful servants to be Allah's supporters at all times, in all their statements and actions, sacrificing their selves and wealth. Allah orders them to accept His and His Messenger's call, just as the disciples said to Prophet Isa when he said, *<4 -It & } 4Who are my helpers (in the cause) of Allah?}* meaning, *Vho will support me in conveying the Message of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored?}* }The Hawdriyyun said:} in reference to the followers of Isa, peace be upon him, *4-it 4We are Allah's helpers}* meaning, "we will support you with regards to the Message you have been sent with and will help you convey it.' Whereby, "Isa sent the disciples to the various areas of Ash-Sham to call the Greeks and the Israelites to Islam. Similarly, during the days of Hajj, Allah's Messenger jg used to ask, «Who will support me in conveying the Message of my Lord? Verily, the Quraysh have prevented me from conveying the Message ofmy Lord . »• 11 Allah the Exalted and Most Honored raised Al-Aws and Al- Khazraj to support the Prophet sg. They were the residents of t1 * Ahmad 3 :322 , Al-H\$kim 2 :624 and Al-Bayhaqi 8 :146

Al-Madinah who gave the pledge to him and supported him, vowing to protect him from mankind and the Jinns if he migrated to them. When he migrated to them with his Companions, they fulfilled their vow to Allah. This is the reason why Allah and His Messenger sg called them, Al-Ansar, the Supporters. The name became synonymous with them. May Allah be pleased with them and please them, as well. A Group of the Children of Israel believed in *isa and a Group ofThem disbelieved Allah said, *iThen a group of the Children of Israel believed and a group disbelieved.\$* When "Isa, peace be on him, conveyed the Message of his Lord to his people and the disciples supported him, a group from the Children of Israel believed. They accepted the guidance that 'Isa brought to them, while another group, was led astray. This group rejected what 'Isa brought them, denied his prophethood and invented

terrible lies about him and his mother. They are the Jews, may Allah curse them until the Day of Judgement. Another group exaggerated over Isa, until they elevated him to more than the level of prophethood that Allah gave him. They divided into sects and factions, some saying that Isa was the son of Allah, while others said that he was one in a trinity, and this is why they invoke the father, the son and the holy ghost! Some of them said that isa was Allah, as we mentioned in the Tafsir of Surat An-Nisa'^ Allah gives Victory to the Believing Group Allah said, ipZ& ip:\$ iSo, We gave power to those who believed against their enemies, [1) See volume three, the Tafsiroi SuratAn-Nisa' (4 :171).

627Surah 61 . As-Saff (14) (Part-28 that is, We gave them victory over the group of Christians which defied them,' iand they became the victorious (uppermost) .> 'over the disbelieving group, whenWe sent Muhammad.' Imam Abu JaYar bin Jarir At-Tabari reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "When Allah decided to raise Isa to heaven, 'Isa went to his companions while drops of water were dripping from his head. At that time, there were twelve men at the house. Isa said to them, 'Some of you will disbelieve in me twelve times after having believed in me.' He then asked, Who among you volunteers that he be made to resemble me and be killed instead of me; he will be with me in my place (in Paradise).' One of the youngest men present volunteered, but 'Isa commanded him to sit down. Isa repeated his statement and the young man again stood up and volunteered, and Isa again told him to sit down. Isa repeated the same statement and the young man volunteered. This time, 'Isa said, Then it will be you.' The appearance of Isa was cast upon that young man, while 'Isa, peace be on him, was raised to heaven through an opening in the roof of the house. The Jews came looking for Isa and arrested the one that appeared as him, killing him by crucifixion. Some of them disbelieved in Isa twelve times, after they had believed in him. They divided into three groups. One group, Al-Ya'qubiyah (the Jacobites), stud, 'Allah remained with us as much as He walled and then ascended to heaven.' Another group, An-Nasturiyyah (the Nestorians), said, 'Allah's son remained with us as much as Allah walled and He then rased him up to heaven.' A third group said, 'Allah's servant and Messenger remained vrith us as much as Allah willed and then Allah raised him up to Him.' The last group was the Muslim group. The two disbelieving groups collaborated against the Muslim group and annihilated it. Islam remained unjustly concealed until Allah sent Muhammad jg, iThen a group of the Children of Israel believed and a group disbelieved.) This Ayah refers to the group among the Children of Israel

that disbelieved and the group that believed, during the time of "Isa, iy»wU j/yJ* lE»l» iSo, We gave power to those who believed against their enemies, and they became the victorious (uppermost).^ through the victory that Muhammad 3^5 gained over the religion of the disbelievers, which brought the dominance of their religion."111 This is the wording in his book for the Tafsir of this honorable Ayah. Similarly, An-Nasal collected this statement of Ibn 'Abbas in his Sunan.'2' Therefore, the Ummah of Muhammad will always be prevalent on the truth until Allah's command (the Final Hour) commences, while they are on this path. The last group of them will fight against Ad-Dajjal along with 'Isa, peace be on him, according to Hadiths in the authentic collections.'31

Surah 62: Al-Jumu'ah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5913]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-Jumu'ah (Chapter - 62)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5913–5932]

The Virtues of SuratAl-Jumu'ah Ibn 'Abbas and Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger used to recite SuratAl-Jumu'ah and SuratAl-Munafiq during the Friday Prayer. Muslim collected this Hadith in his Sahih}^ In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. J3 jj \jr#zm J&i ^ yu^ te j4T\ & >4^' & |iri jj j2m)1 ji iifj »hj *;yj 41 - W7tfl/soeuer is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth glorifies Allah - the King, the Holy, the Almighty, the All-Wise> 42. He it is FWio sent among the unlettered ones a Messenger from among themselves, reciting to them His Aydt, purifying them, and teaching them the Book and the Hikmah. And verily, they had been before in manifest error. \$ 43. And others among them who have not yet joined than. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise> 44. That is the grace of Allah, which He bestows on wlwm He wills. And Allah is the Owner ofmighty gracedby Everything praises and glorifies Allah Allah states that everything in the heavens and the earth glorifies His praises, including all types of living creatures and inanimate objects. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, m Muslim 2:597,599.

iGlorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise (17:44) Allah said, iJ-jM 30} ithe King, the Holy,} meaning that He is the Owner and King of the heavens and the earth Who has perfect control over their affairs. He is the Holy, free of all shortcomings, His attributes are perfect, ii&S ithe Almighty, the All-Wise.} whose explanation is already discussed in many places. The Favor that Allah grantedby sendingMuhammad jg Allah the Exalted said. <Ei 4& & 4He it is Who sent among the unlettered ones a Messenger from among themselves,} the word 'unlettered' here refers to the Arabs. Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, Jjb Ijlt.J 4 iyjl cyJJ J*j} ff r* * lit 4And say to those who were given the Scripture and those who are illiterates : "Do you submit yourselves? If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they him away, your duty is only to convey the message; and Allah is All-Seer of (His) servants.} (3:20) Mentioning the unlettered ones in specific here does not mean that Muhammad jg was only sent to them, because the blessing to the Arabs is greater than that of other nations. In another Ayah, Allah said, *££} 4And verily, this is indeed a Reminder for you and your

632Surah 62. Al-lumu'ah (1-4) (Part-28 people (43:44). Surely, the Qur'an is also a reminder for those other than Arabs to take heed. Allah the Exalted said, <Awf warn your tribe of near kindred.} (26:214)

These Apat do not negate Allah's statements, ^ 4i > li&S 3*^ iSay : "O mankind! verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah." (7:158), and, i that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach." (6:19) and in His statement about the Qur'an, iBut those of the groups that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place." (11:17) There are other Ayat that indicate that his Message is universal. He, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him, was sent to all people, mankind and the Jinns alike. We mentioned this meaning before in Surat Al-An'am producing various Ayat and Hadiths. All praise and thanks are to due to Allah. This Ayah testifies that Allah has indeed accepted the invocation of His friend Ibrahim when he supplicated Allah to send a Messenger to the people of Makkah from among them their own. One who will recite to them Allah's statements, purify them and teach them the Book and the Hikmah. So, Allah - all praise and thanks be to Him - sent him when the Messengers ceased and the way was obscure. Indeed it was a time when it was most needed. Especially since Allah hated the people of the earth, Arabs and non-Arabs alike, except for a few of the People of the Scripture, who kept to the true faith Allah the Exalted sent to Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him. This is why Allah said, ;•&< & iju& \$y s~Vt 4^ djr»

J? jt iff c4> 4He it is Who sent among the unlettered ones a Messenger from among themselves, reciting to them His Ayat, purifying them, and teaching them the Book and the Hikmah. And verily, they had been before in manifest error.) In ancient times, the Arabs used to adhere by the religion of Ibrahim, peace be upon him. They later changed, corrupted and contradicted it, choosing polytheism instead of Tawhid. and doubts instead of certainty. They invented a religion that Allah did not legislate, just as the People of the Scriptures did when they changed and corrupted their Divine Books. Allah sent Muhammad jj\$, with a great divine legislation, perfect religion that is suitable for all humans and Jinns. In it, there is guidance and explanations of all that they need in this life and the Hereafter. It draws them closer to Paradise and Allah's pleasure and takes them away from the Fire and earning Allah's anger. In it, there is the final judgement for all types of doubts and suspicion for all major and minor matters of the religion. In Muhammad sg, Allah gathered all the good qualities of the Prophets before him, and gave him what He has never given the earlier and later generations of mankind. May Allah's peace and blessings be on Muhammad until the Day of Judgement. Muhammad^ is the Messenger to Arabs and Non-Arabs alike Allah said, iAnd others among them who have not yet joined them. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise.) Imam Abu 'Abdullah Al-Bukhari, may Allah have mercy upon him, recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, "We were sitting with the Prophet &&, when Surat Al-Jumu'ah was revealed to him; 'M &ups)And others among them who have not yet joined them.) They said, "Who are they, O Allah's Messenger?" The Prophet

633Surah 62. Al-lumu'ah (1-4) <Part-28) did not reply until they repeated the question thrice. At that time, Salman Al-Farisi was with us. So Allah's Messenger ^placed his hand on Salman, saying, "5* ilrf ~ J4-J j' - J aIIJ x# OlijVl jJ» faith were on Ath-Thurayyd (Pleiades), even then some men or a man from these people would attain it)"Ili Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir coUected this Hadith.m This Hadlth indicates that Surat Al- Jumu'ah was revealed in Al-Madlnah and that the Messenger's Message is universal. The Prophet m explained Allah's statement, ipri t/^j} iAnd others among them}' by mentioning Persia. This is why the Prophet sg sent messages to the kings of Persia and Rome, among other kings, calling them to Allah the Exalted and to follow what he was sent with. This is why Mujahid and several others said that Allah's statement, i^r ^ *rJ iAnd others among

them who have not yet joined them.} refers to all non-Arabs who believe in the truth of the Prophet.¹³ * Allah's statement, <2%%> iAnd He is the Almighty, the AU-Wise.} asserts that He is Almighty and All-Wise in His legislation and the destiny He appoints. Allah's statement, ,p»3f J* iES J* ijSt 4* JiS <£)&}> iThat is the grace of Allah, which He bestows on whom He wills. And Allah is the Owner of mighty grace.} refers to the great prophethood that He granted Muhammad \$g Fath Al-Bari 8:510. 121 Muslim 4 :1972 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :209 ,10 :433 , An-Nasat in Al- Kubra 5 :75,6:490, and At-Tabari 23 :375 At-Tabari 23 :374

634 TafsTr Ibn Kathir and the qualities that He favored his Ummah with, by sending Muhammad Sg to them. f c\$ UM A te tS V iifj Jif oilL ijpiS"" ol £3 o/, « 4 ^_4-JJuj C-*J>3 UJ 'Jo' k \$ r£ % ^ ^i>U op'f J! oj'O A li ,&\$ jj^DS \$5. The likeness of those who were entrusted with the Tawrah, but did not carry it, is as the likeness of a donkey which carries huge burdens of books. How bad is the example of people who deny the Ayat of Allah . And Allah does not guide the people who are wrongdoers . 46. Say: "O you Jews! If you pretend that you are friends of Allah, to the exclusion of (all) other people, then long for death if you are truthful."> 47. But they will never long for it, because of what their hands have sent before them! And Allah knows well the wrongdoers 48. Say : "Verily, the death from which you flee, will surely meet you, then you will be sent back to the Knower of the unseen and the seen, and He will inform you about what you

used to do."} Admonishing the Jews and challenging them to wish for Death Allah the Exalted admonishes the Jews who were entrusted with the Tawrah and were ordered to abide by it. However, they did not abide by it, and this is why Allah resembled them to the donkey that carries volumes of books. Surely, when the donkey carries books, it will not understand what these books contain because it is only carrying these books using its strength. This is the example of those who were entrusted with the Tawrah; they read its letter but did not understand its meanings nor abided by them. Rather, they even corrupted and changed the Tawrah. Therefore, they are worse than the donkey, because the donkey cannot understand. They, on the other hand, could have understood using their minds, but their minds were of no benefit. This is why Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah, S&x j; ^} iThey are like cattle, nay even more astray; those! They are the heedless.} (7:179), and said, pift V iiltj jif fyif JIL^ iHow bad is the example of people who deny the Ayat of Allah. And Allah does not guide the people who are wrongdoers.} Allah the Exalted said, A ijil & j. & p -p- [fli (fe \$) 4Say : "O you Jews! If you pretend that you are friends of Allah, to the exclusion of other people, then long for death if you are truthful."} meaning, *if you claim that you are on the correct guidance and that Muhammad and his Companions are being led astray, then invoke Allah to bring death to the misguided group among the two, if you are truthful in your claim.' Allah said.

4^4 £0 %}> iBut they will never long for it, because of what their hands have sent before them!} meaning because of the disbelief, injustice and sins that they commit, 4U^^i '(& iAnd Allah knows well the wrongdoers . ^ We mentioned this challenge to the Jews before in Surat Al- Baqarah, where Allah said, lj~; . : i uJUl jjj ui <ii' -Lt jliJ' ^sO oit? oi t . 3* "j » ^ y ^ri % i&il aji £ oslSfl >4 ®1> >4 ^ •s' 1^ <Si -**££? 4Sai/ ; "/// the home of the Hereafter ivith Allah is indeed for you specially and not for others, of mankind, then long for death if you are truthful." But they will never long for it because of what their hands have sent forth before them. And Allah is Aware of the wrongdoers. And verily, you will find

them the greediest of mankind for life and (even greedier) than those who ascribe partners to Allah . One of them wishes that he could be given a life of a thousand years. But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from punishment. And Allah is Seer of what they do.} (2:94-96) We explained these meanings there, stating that the challenge was for the Jews to invoke Allah to destroy the misguided group, either they or their enemies. We also mentioned a similar challenge against the Christians in Surah Al 'Imran, erag jls jff i oi£&aJ & jj ps&; £2\$; iThen whoever disputes with you concerning him flsd] after (all this) knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let us call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves - then we pray and invoke the curse of

Allah upon those who lie."\$(3:61) and against the idolators, in Surah Maryam, 4 *£ j j-iii cr iSay whoever is in error, the Most Gracious will extend [circumstances]for him>(19:75) Imam Ahmad, may Allah be pleased with him recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, said. If I see Muhammad praying at the Ka'bah, I will step on his neck.' When the Prophet jg heard of that, he said, O^aJl `jm jlj fj f 3y| <il dfl-j ^jjl 'fl'j tjllll JA Wu «Had he done so, the angels would have snatched him away in public. Had the jews wished for death, they would all have perished and saw their seats in Hellfire. Had those accepted for invoking the curse of Allah with Allah's Messenger, they would not have found families or property when they returned home.»"ll] Al-Bukhan, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa"! recorded it His saying; 'r-r-***' -fir* ^ i-SjJ' ili<yS\ <@ys ft e. ^Say : "Verily, the death from which you flee will surely meet you, then you will be sent back to the Knower of the unseen and the seen, and He will inform you about what you used to do."\$ is like His saying in Surat An-Nisa *}£* pam £&> iWheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you * * Ahmad 1:248. See Surah Al 'Imr&n (3:61) in volume two for the meaning of Mubalahah. Fath Al-Bari 8 :590, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :277 and An-Nasal in Al- Kubrd 6:518, 308.

are in fortresses built up strong and high.} £j" L& it Si \$ &Sf£ M 1JJ4 'H '& otWj4\$ 4^ 6\$ £H kt it 1*9; it .Li 49. O i/ow who believe! When the call is proclaimed for the Salah on Al-Jumu'ah (Friday), then hasten (Fas'aw) to the remembrance of Allah and leave off business. That is better for you if you did but know!} \$10. Then when the Salah is complete, you may disperse through t'l'e land, and seek the bounty of Allah, and remember Allah much, that you may be successful.} Al-Jumu'ah (Friday), and the Orders and Etiquette for Friday Friday is called Al-Jumu'ah because it is derived from Al-Jam', literally, gathering. The people of Islam gather weekly, on every Friday in the major places of worship. It was during Friday when Allah finished the creation, the sixth day, during which Allah created the heavens and earth. During Friday, Allah created Adam, and he was placed in Paradise, and ironically, it was a Friday when he was taken out of Paradise. It will be on a Friday when the Last Hour will commence. There is an hour during Friday, wherein no faithful servant asks Allah for something good, but Allah will give him what he asked for. All of this is based upon Hadiths in the authentic collections. In the ancient language Friday was called, 'Arubah. It is a fact that previous nations were informed about Friday, but they were led astray from it. The Jews chose Saturday for their holy day, but Adam was not created on Saturday. The Christians chose Sunday, which is the day the creation was initiated. Allah chose Friday for this Ummah, because it is the day the creation was finished. Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, ? , fi f I %m « 11a 01 i LLi lyjf p-gJ 1 1*1 Jill UljLgj JIL lAaUgJl OJ^j-Vl Jill *y.

JtP Jm jJjLiijIj Ijlp 2jj.'.) I “We are the last (to come) but the first on the Day of Resurrection, though the former nations were given the Scriptures before us. And this was their day (Friday) the celebration of which was made compulsory for them, but they differed about it. So, Allah gave us guidance to it, and all other people are coming after us: the Jews tomorrow and the Christians the day after tomorrow.”^ This is the wording of Al-Bukhari in another narration of Muslim; fjd ‘V-r-! fji iji-h ‘lit jLS “J» -fi- Jill OyljIJ 4)1 til 4)1 i\So virfii }y. idiu j* jjy^vi iioii^ iij ^^ JjuJSj •jj'iUji jj “Allah diverted those who were before us from Friday. For the Jews there was Saturday, and for the Christians there was Sunday. Allah then brought us and guided us to Friday. He made them; Friday, Saturday and Sunday, and it is in this order they will come after us on the Day of Resurrection. We are the last of among the people of this world and the first among the created to be judged on the Day of Resurrection .*|21 Necessity of the Remembrance of Allah on Friday, by attending the Khutbah and the Prayer Allah commanded the believers to gather to worship Him on Friday, j£i <^1 Oi C«Sl (\$£} 40 you who believe! mien the call is proclaimed for the Saldh on Al-Jumu'ah (Friday), then hasten (Fas'aw) to the remembrance of Allah} meaning, go to it and head for it. The meaning of Sa'y (hasten) here does not refer to walking quickly. It only refers to the 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :526 and Muslim 2 :586 I2 ' Muslim 2 :586

640 TafsTr Ibn Kathir importance of it. Umar bin Al-Khattab and Ibn Mas*ud - may Allah be pleased with them - recited it; Ul /i JI \jti\i) (“Then proceed to the remembrance of Allah.”)111 As for walking in haste to the prayer, that was indeed prohibited, since it was recorded in the Two Sahihs from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg said, Ui ^ ^1 UtfVI liU V.J ijuj «When you hear the Iqamah, proceed to offer the prayer with calmness and solemnity and do not rush. And pray whatever you catch, and complete whatever you have missed This is the wording with Al-Bukhari. Abu Qatadah said, “While we were praying behind the Messenger of Allah gr he heard commotion. At the end of the prayer, the Prophet \$g said; U® “IWhat is the matter with i/o?»» They said, *We hastened to the prayer.’The Prophet jg said. Uj Ij*nt j Ui e-j i'&oi I lil 1 jlkjj ^ I vojO «Don’t do that. When you come far prayer, there should be tranquility upon you. Pray what remains of the prayer and complete what you have missed. n”*31 The Two Sahths collected this Hadith. Al-Hasan commented, “By Allah! Hastening to the prayer is not accomplished by the feet. Indeed they were prohibited from coming to prayer without tranquility and dignity. Rather it is about the hearts, the intention, and the submission.” Qatadah said, At-Tabari 23:381. ^ Fath Al-Bari 2 :138 and Muslim 1 :420 * Fath Al-Bari 2 :137 and Muslim 1 :422 .

“ithen hasten to the remembrance of Allah} means that you have to hasten to the prayer with your heart and actions, and walk to it.”111 It is recommended for those coming to the Friday prayer to perform Ghusl (taking bath) before they come. It is collected in the Two Sahihs that ‘Abdullah bin “Umar said that Allah’s Messenger said, i[>- IS) *When one of you comes to the Friday prayer, then let him perform bathM2 ' The Two Sahihs recorded that Abu Said said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, *Ghusl on the day of Jumu'ah is Wdjib (required) from every Muhtalimj|31 Abu Hurayrah narrated that Allah's Messenger \$\$ said, *^.\j Jj ^ fill JS Ifi- & IIt is Allah's right on every Muslim to bathe during every seven days, by washing his head and bodyj Muslim collected this HadithJ4 Jabir narrated that Allah’s Messenger^ said, ^ f>: 'J <4 & 'J ^Within every seven days, every Muslim man has the obligation to perform Ghusl at least one day, the day of Jumu'ah. Ahmad, An-Nasal and Ibn Hibban collected this Hadith)^ 111 At-Tabari 23:380. 121 Fath Al-Bari 2 :415 and Muslim 2 :579 I3 ' Fath Al-

Bari 2 :415 and Muslim 2 :580. Muhtalim is a male who has reached the age of puberty MusUm 2:582. | s| Ahmad 3 :304 , An-Nasal 3 :93 , and Ibn Hibban 2 :262

Virtues of Jumu'ah Imam Ahmad recorded that 'Aws bin 'Aws Ath-Thaqafi said that he heard Allah's Messenger say, i j&Xj 'Mj \y. J^3 l d ii'S ^Whoever performs Ghusl (well) on the day of Jumu'ah, leaves early, walking not riding, and sits close to the Imam and listens without talking, will earn the reward of fasting and performing standing (in prayer) for an entire year for every step he takes. This Hadith has various chains of narration, the compilers of the Four Sunan collected it, and At-Tirmidhi graded it Hasan.¹² ' The Two SahZhs also recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah gg said. c,) dfo jfi jpiui j £0 p jil uiAii j^i iiJiiJi ii-iui j £.13 ^3 ^3* 031 g&i uiui ^ £13 ^3 .i i; ^3 4-y j ^13 3^3 ^35! 4.3s uH& u-iiJi j £13 • • 1 " > * , 0 i) s&SLji i^uJi SpiiJi j £13 "Any person who takes a bath on Friday like the bath for sexual impurity and then goes for the prayer in the first hour, it is as if he had sacrificed a camel . Whoever goes in the second hour, it is as if he had sacrificed a cow. Whoever goes in the third hour, then it is as if he had sacrificed a homed ram. If one goes in the fourth hour, then it is as if he had sacrificed a hen. Whoever goes in the fifth hour, then it is as if he had offered an egg. When the Impm appears, the angels present themselves to listen to Allah's remembrancer¹³¹ It is recommended that one cleans his body, performs Ghusl, Ahmad 4:9. 121 Abu Dawud 1 :246, 247, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3:3, An-Nasal 3:95, 97, and Ibn Majah 1 :246. 131 Fath Al-Bari 2 :425 and Muslim 2 :582

643 Surah 62. Al-Iumu'ah (9-10) (Part-28) wears his best clothes, applies perfume and uses Siwak (tooth stick) for Jumu'ah. We mentioned that Abu Said narrated that the Messenger of Allah said, «Ghitsl on the day of Jumu'ah is Wdjib (required) from every Muhtalim and also using Siwdk and applying some of his household's perfumeJ Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Ayyub Al-Ansari said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, oJLLe- ijj (j~aj I b) C.— plj a3 lJU ijJ jj JL>t—xJl ^JL •^>^1 UJ i^us^ JJs; Jj* Jj- liui ^Whoever performs Ghusl on Friday and applies perfume, if he has any, wears his best clothes, then goes to the Masjid and performs voluntary prayer, if he wishes, does not bother anyone, listens when the Imam appears until he starts the prayer. Then all of this will be an expiation for whatever occurs between that Friday and the next Friday »|2' Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded in their Sunans that 'Abdullah bin Salam said that he heard the Messenger of Allah say, while on the Minbar. * # x «* % > "ir*?Uy <Jy? y fy). Je.y f J lil1 uWhat harm would it cause if one of you bought two garments for the day of Jumu'ah, other than the garment he wears daily?'^3] 'A'ishah said that during a speech he gave on a Friday when he saw people wearing Nimar garments,¹⁴¹ the Messenger of Allah said, y ^ X ^ ^ (, X ^ I ^ X x ^ J X 111 FathAl-Bari 2:423. 121 Ahmad 5:420. 131 Ahmad 1 : 650 and Ibn Majah 1 :348 A type of cloak the Arabs wore

644 TafaTr Ibn Kathir zWheti one of you has wealth, he should keep two garments for Friday, other than the two garments he has for his daily wear. » Ibn Majah collected this Hadith. [11 The Meaning of the Call in the Ayah is the Adhan that precedes the Khutbah Allah said, ty. It ^Jiy iWhen the call is proclaimed for the Salah on Friday,} referring to the Adhan which was called, during the time of the Prophet jg, when he came out of his house and sat on the Minbar. The Adhan would be called before the Prophet jg near the door of the Masjid. As for the earlier Adhan that the Leader of the faithful, TJthman bin Affan added, it was done because the Muslims increased in number during his time. Al-Bukhari

recorded that As-Sa'ib bin Yazid said, "In the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ, Abu Bakr and 'Umar, the Adhan for the Friday prayer was pronounced while the Imam sat on the pulpit. But during 'Uthman's later time when the Muslims increased in number, an additional call was pronounced upon Az-Zawra', meaning the Adhan was called upon the house which was called Az-Zawra' "12 ' Az-Zawra' was the tallest house in Al-Madlnah near the Masjid. Prohibiting buying and selling after the Call on Friday, and the Exhortation to seek Provisions after it Allah said, *ip^ iand leave off business .}* means, hastening to the remembrance of Allah and abandoning business, when the call to the Friday prayer is made. Therefore, the scholars of Islam agree, it is prohibited for Muslims to engage in business transactions after the second Adhan. Allah's statement, Ibn Majah 1 :349. 121 FathAl-Bdri 2:457.

4That is better for you if you did but know!) means, 'your abandoning buying and selling, and instead, concentrating your attention to Allah's remembrance and the prayer are better for you in this life and the Hereafter, if you but knew.' Allah's statement, *Then when the Salah is complete,}* means, when the Friday prayer is finished, *j- \£Xj Jfjti ^ 4*you may disperse through the land, and seek the bounty of Allah,) After Allah forbade Muslims from working after hearing the Adhan and ordered them to gather for the Friday prayer, He allowed them to spread throughout the earth and seek bounty after the prayer is finished. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that when the Friday prayer finished, Irak bin Malik would stand by the gate of the Masjid and invoke Allah, saying, "O Allah! I have accepted and complied with Your Call, performed the prayer You ordered and dispersed as You ordered me. Therefore, grant me of Your favor and You are the best of those who grant provisions." Allah's statement, *pi)and remember Allah much, that you may be successful.}* means, while you are buying and selling, giving and taking, remember Allah much and do not let this life busy you from what benefits you in the Hereafter. There is a Hadlth that states, *uiLjl aJ i<J Y aj>-3 lil Yj y : Jlii \ijZ. will <s- l wiji will J ill wis LjiJj JuAll ilj wiif m* Al-Qurtubi 18:108.

*^ t&mm •mmw^ iiUrJi ijUJSCj&\£f>_ ^^ o^«JLu oj>Jjiiij^Ui] xilJ_i*s) j*i£jlj K mm&n p%\$>\$ji^d! ii^Si jlsS^WUii* "Whoever enters a marketplace and says, "La ildha illalldh, He is alone without partners, His is the sovereignty and His is the praise, and He is Able to do all things." Then Allah will record a thousand-thousand (a million) good deeds for him and will erase a thousand-thousand evil deeds. Mujahid said, "A servant (of Allah) will not be among those who remember Allah often, until he does so while standing, sitting and lying down." *ip»L(\jL jl \j£Z. Ijij jii^ X* U Ji Lgji Af^ij IjjJ) «>*j ij*j yP o' fr jy- ill* And when they see some merchandise or some amusement, they disperse headlong to it, and leave you standing. Say: "That which Allah has is better than any amusement or merclwndise! And Allah is the best of providers.' The Prohibition of leaving the Masjid while the Imam is delivering the Friday Sermon Allah criticizes what happened during one Friday sermon, when a caravan arrived at Al-Madlnah and the people rushed *^ Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:386.* Many of the scholars consider this Hadith to be unauthentic . Al-Hakim , Ash-Shawkani , Ibn Taymiyah and Al-Albani are among those who consider it acceptable

out to the merchandise. Allah said, *£5i (ji jl V/j. bt> 4*Atid when they see some merchandise or some amusement, they disperse headlong to it, and leave you standing. meaning, on the Minbar, delivering the Khutbah. Several of the Tabi'in said this, such as Abu Al-'Aliyah, Al-Hasan, Zayd bin Aslam and Qatadah Muqatil bin Hayyan said that the caravan belonged to Dihyah bin Khalifah before he became a

Muslim, and there were drums accompanying it. So they rushed to the caravan and left Allah's Messenger standing on the Minbar. Only a few remained, according to the authentic Hadith that Imam Ahmad recorded that Jabir said, "Once, a caravan arrived at Al-Madīnah while Allah's Messenger was giving a Khutbah. So, the people left, and only twelve men remained [with the Messenger]. Then Allah sent down this Ayah, 'And when they see some merchandise or some amusement, they disperse headlong to it,'"²¹ The Two Sahih's also recorded this Hadith³ ^ Allah's statement, 'And leave you standing.'} proves that the Imam should deliver the speech on Friday while standing. In his Sahih, Imam Muslim recorded that Jabir bin Samurah said, "(During Jumu'ah,) the Prophet gave two speeches, and he used to sit between them. The Prophet would recite the Qur'an and remind the people (of Allah)."⁴¹ Allah's statement, At-Tabari 23:387. •2| Ahmad 3:313. Fath Al-Bari 8 :51 1 and Muslim 2 :590 Muslim 2 :589

⁴Say : "That which Allah has..."} means the reward that is with Allah in the Hereafter, Jto- **it) oj 4is better than any amusement or merchandise! And Allaft is the best of providers.} means, for those who trust in Him and seek His provisions when they are allowed to do so.

Surah 63: Al-Munafiqun

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5933–5944]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Munafiqun (Chapter - 63) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah J-ag*^0P *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 14 iiltj /!_Jif I \j p\ iff) ijJli -Jit IjT 6 & #\j\$ £ to & (Hpi ^ jP !t^ p !£** (*r\ 'jU'i CpAj^d ^ £i£ ^ \jp 4; JjaSS^ «@oj& J^ &£S jtn 2 41. W7ie?i the hypocrites come to you, they say: “We bear witness that you are indeed the Messenger of Allah.” Allah knows that you are indeed His Messenger, and Allah bears witness that the hypocrites are liars indeed.} 42. They have made their oaths a screen. Thus they hinder (others) from the path of Allah. Verily, evil is what they used to do.} 43. Tlmt is because they believed, and then disbelieved; therefore their hearts are sealed, so they understand not.} 44. And when you look at them, their bodies please you; and when they speak, you listen to their words. They are as blocks of wood propped up. They think that every cry is against them. They are the enemies, so beware of them. May Allah curse them! How are they denying the right path?} The Case of the Hypocrites and their Behavior Allah the Exalted states that the hypocrites pretended to be Muslims when they went to the Prophet jg. In reality, they were not Muslims, but rather the opposite. This is why Allah the Exalted said,

<3\ff} <J&1 Jyli 5y£S\ 2'X. }When the hypocrites come to you, they say: 'We bear witness that you are indeed the Messenger of Allah.'} meaning, “when the hypocrites come to you, they announce this statement and pretend to believe in it.” Allah informs that there is no substance to their statement, and this is why He said, pz \$j} iAllah knows that you are indeed His Messenger,} then said. iAnd Allah bears witness that the hypocrites are liars indeed.} meaning, their claims, even though it is true about the Prophet. But they did not believe inwardly in what they declared outwardly, and this is why Allah declared their falsehood about their creed. Allah’s statement, ft- bJLi iThey have made their oaths a screen. Thus they hinder (others) from the path of Allah.} meaning, the hypocrites shield themselves from Muslims when they falsely and sinfully swear to be what they are not in reality. Some Muslims were deceived because they did not know their falsehood, and thus, thought that they were Muslims. Some Muslims believed what hypocrites say and even imitated them in their outward behavior. However, inwardly, hypocrites seek the destruction of Islam and its people, and this is why trusting them might bring great harm to many people. This is why Allah said next, \j% C \$£. pf\ \jxft} iThus they hinder (others) from the path of Allah. Verily, evil is what they used to do. Allah said, |il At-Jabari 23 :394

651 Surah 63. Al-Munafiqun (1-4) (Part-28) iThat is because they believed, and then disbelieved; therefore their hearts are sealed, so they understand not.} meaning, He has decreed them to be hypocrites because they reverted from faith to disbelief and exchanged guidance for misguidance.

Therefore, Allah stamped and sealed their hearts and because of it, they cannot comprehend the guidance, nor any goodness can reach their hearts. Truly, their hearts neither understand, nor attain guidance. Allah said, *1h* o!j > \>|j} 4*And when you look at them, their bodies please you; and when they speak, you listen to their words.} meaning, hypocrites have a graceful outer appearance and are eloquent. When one hears them speak, he will listen to then- eloquent words, even though hypocrites are truly weak and feeble, full of fear, fright and cowardice. Allah's statement, *4*They think that every cry is against them.} means, every time an incident occurs or something frightening happens, they think that it is headed their way. This is indicative of their cowardice, just as Allah said about them, *U£& 4? \$ \$& SP % ty iSJ} i Sp xs% *pT *£3& i*Being miserly towards you then when fear comes, you will see them looking to you, their eyes revolving like (those of) one over whom hovers death; but when the fear departs, they will smite you with sharp tongues, miserly towards good. Such have not believed. Therefore Allah makes their deeds fruitless and that is ever easy *Jbr Allah.*} (33:19) They are shapes that do not have much substance, why Allah said, and this is *i*They are the enemies, so beware of them. May Allah curse them! How are they denying the right path?}

652 Tafsir Ibn Kathir means, how they are being led astray to the misguidance, away from the guidance. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Prophet *ig*; said, *y <Jp (> Vfr* p-e-*tiij Zii : If; jf'p J-iillliJ j!« 'll i \jii 'll) o^LdJl 'ij c Mj J!>-L1UI jy'y^_ 4^ - 5'jj 4^*<J^; 4-^- ' «*Hypocrites have certain signs that they are known by. Their greeting is really a curse, their food is from stealing and the war booty they collect is from theft. They shun the Masjid and they do not come to the prayer but at its end. They are arrogant; it is neither easy for them to blend in, nor it is easy for people to blend with them. They are like pieces of wood by night and are noisy by day *P oj& \ \$ \$ P Ji J* P& tip Sr'S Sjsi ffc '4-4 \$ \$)£ Cfif jU £jjjf •\$ \jPj eg jJjZ y o&Zii 'JQj u?jVf) o<J>- ^sjj i^iLi .44# jjJ* AS foff£ >Vr 24^4 «JT J! 45.* And when it is said to them: "Come, so that the Messenger of Allah may ask forgiveness from Allah for you," they twist their heads, and you would see them turning away their faces in pride.) 46. It is equal to them whether you ask forgiveness or ask not forgiveness for them, Allah will never forgive them. Verily, Allah guides not the people who are the rebellious.) ^ Ahmad 2:293. This was also recorded by Al-Bazzar & It contains a narrator who most of the scholars consider unacceptable, he is alone with this narration, and he is the only one who narrates from the person he says he heard it from. For such reasons Ibn Hibban included this narration in Al-Majruhn, saying that it is not allowed to use him as a proof.

47. They are the ones who say: "Spend not on those who are with Allah's Messenger, until they desert him." And to Allah belong the treasures of the heavens and the earth, but the hypocrites comprehend not. 48. They say: "If we return to Al-Madinah, indeed the more honorable will expel therefrom the weaker." But Al-Izzah belongs to Allah, and to His Messenger, and to the believers, but the hypocrites know not. Hypocrites are not interested to ask the prophet *jg* to ask Allah to forgive them Allah the Exalted states about the hypocrites, may Allah curse them, *4'^jv [jji Jy*j jiiii> ijiii p jj \s\y} 4*And when it is said to them: "Come, so that the Messenger of Allah may ask forgiveness from Allah for you," they twist their heads,} meaning, they turn away, ignoring this call in arrogance, belittling what they are invited to. This is why Allah the Exalted said, *(T*J OjXuu 4*and you would see them turning away their faces in pride.} Allah punished them for this behavior, saying, *iSxf i in' o[p iii J pi 'jycSi f pt ojliU J-pc- %J^} 4 v pjli 4*It is equal to them whether you ask forgiveness or ask not forgiveness for them,

Allah will never forgive them. Verily, Allah guides not the people who are the rebellious.} As Allah said in Surat Bara'ah, and a discussion preceded there, and here we will present some of the Hadiths reported that are related to it. Several of the Salaf mentioned that this entire passage was revealed in the case of 'Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul, as we will soon mention, Allah willing and our trust and reliance are on Him. U1 See the volume four, the Tafslr of SuratAt-Tawbah (9 :80)

In his book, As-Sirah, Muhammad bin Ishaq said, "After the battle of Uhud ended, the Prophet jg returned to Al-Madlnah. 'Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul - as Ibn Shihab narrated to me - would stand up every Friday, without objection from anyone because he was a chief of his people, when the Prophet m would sit on the Minbar, just before he delivered the Jumu'ah Khutbah to the people. 'Abdullah bin Ubay would say, 'O people! This is the Messenger of Allah with you. Allah has honored us by sending him and gave you might through him. Support him, honor him and listen to and obey him.' He would then sit down. So after the battle of Uhud, even after he did what he did, that is, returning to Al-Madlnah with a third of the army, he stood up to say the same words. But the Muslims held on to his clothes and said to him, 'Sit down, O enemy of Allah! You are not worthy to stand after you did what you did.' 'Abdullah went out of the Masjid crossing people's lines and saying, *By Allah, it is as if I said something awful when I wanted to support him.' Some men from Al- Ansar met him at the gate of the Masjid and asked him what happened. He said, 1 just stood up to support him and some men, his Companions, jumped at me, pulled me back and admonished me, as if what I said was an awful thing; I merely wanted to support him.' They said to him, 'Woe to you! Go back so that Allah's Messenger jg asks Allah to forgive you.' He said, TBy Allah, I do not wish that he ask Allah to forgive me.' ** 1 Qatadah and As-Suddi said, "This Ayah was revealed about 'Abdullah bin Ubay. A young relative of his went to Allah's Messenger sg and conveyed to him an awful statement that 'Abdullah said. The Messenger sg called 'Abdullah, who swore by Allah that he did not say anything. The Ansar went to that boy and admonished him. However, Allah sent down what you hear about 'Abdullah's case and Allah's enemy was told, 'Go to Allah's Messenger,' but he turned his head away, saying that he will not do it." Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Muhammad bin Yahya bin Hibban, 'Abdullah bin Abi Bakr and 'Asim bin Tlmar bin Qatadah narrated to him the stoiy of Bani Al-Mustaliq. They *** Ibn Hisham 3:111. * At-Jabari 23 :399

said that while the Messenger of Allah jg was in that area, Jahjah bin Said Al-Ghifari, a hired hand for Umar, and Sinan bin Wabr fought over the water source. Sinan called out, "O Ansar", while Al-Jahjah called, "O Muhajirin!" Zayd bin Arqam and several Ansar men were sitting with 'Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul at that time. When 'Abdullah heard what happened, he said, "They are bothering us in our land. By Allah, the parable of us and these foolish Quraysh men, is the parable that goes, 'Feed your dog until it becomes strong, and it will eat you.' By Allah, when we go back to Al-Madinah, the most mighty will expel the weak from it." He then addressed his people who were sitting with him, saying to them, "What have you done to yourselves? You let them settle in your land and shared your wealth with them. By Allah, if you abandon them, they will have to move to another area other than yours." Zayd bin Arqam heard these words and conveyed them to Allah's Messenger jg. Zayd was a young boy then. Umar bin Al-Khattab was with the Messenger and he said, "O Allah's Messenger! Order 'Abbad bin Bishr to cut off his head at his neck." The Prophet jg replied, J <'1 |JU>J jl 'fJ- u r.0l Ijl _aISo« 'What if people started saying that Mulhammad kills his companions, O 'Umar? No. However, order the people

to start the journey (back to Al-Madinah) .» When ‘Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul was told that his statement reached Allah’s Prophet jg, he went to him and denied saying it. He swore by Allah that he did not utter the statement that Zayd bin Arqam conveyed. ‘Abdullah bin Ubay was a chief of his people and they said, “O Allah’s Messenger! May be the young boy merely guessed and did not hear what was said correctly.” Allah’s Messenger jg started the journey at an unusual hour of the day and was met by Usayd bin Al-Hudayr, who greeted him acknowledging his prophethood. Usayd said, “By Allah! You are about to begin the journey at an unusual time.” The Prophet jg said, ^ j I Jli U Ui®

656 TafsTr Ibn Kathir «jiVi it Did not the statement of your friend, Ibn Ubay reach you? He claimed that when he returns to Al-Madinah, the mighty one will expel the weak one out of it .» Usayd said, “Indeed, you are the mighty one, O Allah’s Messenger, and he is the disgraced one.” Usayd said, “Take it easy with him, O Allah’s Messenger! By Allah, when Allah brought you to us, we were about to gather the pearls (of a crown) so that we appoint him king over us. He thinks that you have rid him of his kingship.” The Messenger of Allah Si traveled with the people until the night fell, then the rest of the night until the beginning of the next day and then set camp with the people. He wanted to busy them from talking about what had happened. The minute people felt the ground under their feet, they went to sleep and Surat Al-Munafiqin was revealed. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah said, “We were in a battle with Allah’s Messenger S& and a man from the Emigrants kicked an Ansari man. The Ansari man called out, ‘O Ansari!’ and the Emigrant called out, ‘O Emigrants!’ Allah’s Messenger Si heard that and said, IfejpS JU La uWhat is this call of Jahiliyyah? Abandon it because it is offensive .» ‘Abdullah bin Ubay heard that and said, ‘Have they (the Emigrants) done so? By Allah, if we return to Al-Madinah, surely, the more honorable will expel therefrom the meaner.’ The Ansar at that time, were more numerous than the Emigrants when the Messenger of Allah si came to Al-Madinah, but later on the Emigrants increased in number. When this statement reached the Prophet Si, Umar got up and said, ‘O Allah’s Messenger! Let me chop off the head of this hypocrite!’ The Prophet si said: * J * Ibn Hisham 2:290-292. This and the last two narrations are not authentic, from the view of the chain of narrators. Much of the information can be seen again in the following narrations which are authentic, among them the narration in the Two Sahuhs.

657 Surah 63. Al-Munafiqim (5-8) (Part-28) IV-J> «Leave him, lest the people say that Muhammad kills his companionsJ” ’ Imam Ahmad, 2 ’ Al-Bukhari and Muslim 3 ’ collected this Hadith. ‘Ikrimah and Ibn Zayd and others said that when the Prophet and his Companions went back to Al-Madinah, ‘Abdullah, the son of ‘Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul, remained by the gate of Al-Madinah holding his sword. People passed by him as they returned to Al-Madinah, and then his father came. ‘Abdullah, son of ‘Abdullah, said to his father, “Stay where you are,” and his father asked what the matter was? His son said, “By Allah! You will enter through here until the Messenger of Allah allows you to do so, for he is the honorable one and you are the disgraced.” When the Messenger of Allah Sg came by, and he used to be in the last lines, ‘Abdullah bin Ubay complained to him about his son and his son said, “By Allah, O Allah’s Messenger! He will not enter it until you say so.” The Messenger si gave his permission to ‘Abdullah bin Ubay and his son said, “Enter, now that the Messenger of Allah 3g gave you his permission.” 4 ’ In his Musnad, Abu Bakr ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr Al-Humaydi recorded from Abu Harun Al-Madani that ‘Abdullah, the son of ‘Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul, said to his father, “You will never enter Al-Madinah unless and until you say, ‘Allah’s Messenger Si is the honorable one and I am

the disgraced.” When the Prophet Si came, ‘Abdullah, son of ‘Abdullah bin Ubay bin Salul said to him, “O Allah’s Messenger! I was told that you have decided to have my father executed. By He Who has sent you with Truth, I never looked straight to his face out of respect for him. But if you wish, I will bring you his head, because I would hate to see the killer of my father.”’5’ Dala’il An-Nubuwwah 4 :53 I2 ‘ Ahmad 3 :392 ‘ Al-Bukhari no . 4907 , Muslim no . 2584 I4 ‘ At-Tabari 23 :403, 405. ‘ Musnad Al-Humaydi2 :520

£*£ X \jX c\$ * % iU’j i>*j ji’ j£z=>i Wj j*-* *2lpJjk Ofc c? .p o? (^iu b u? X? yj J& Apt vj p & j»-ij ol> t jwluJt ^ illtj LjjJ it Llii ij)t A Af- ^9. O i/oh who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah. And whosoever does that, then they are the losers.> 410. And spend of that with which We have provided you before death comes to one of you, and he says: "My Lord! If only You would give me respite for a little while, then I should give Sadaqat from my wealth, and be among the righteous> 411. And Allah grants respite to none when his appointed time comes. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.\$ The Importance of not being too concerned with the Matters of the Worldly Life, and being Charitable before Death Allah the Exalted orders His faithful servants to remember Him frequently and to refrain from being distracted from His remembrance by indulging in their properties and children excessively. Allah informs them that those who engage in this life, its delights and attributes and were busied from the y t380S» 000 tgagss# \v. juftji fr’fry*jJUj&Cr*& ^P-pX cfrsjj^0 ^Ajfrfrjfrfr\frjfr}d\ [fr jAAsjjLLJrf]ftA> _J <1 J»AiiLfrjliilly ttMsrWM~mm

659 Surah 63. Al-Munafiqun (9-11) (Part-28) obedience and remembrance of Allah, for which they were created, will be among the losers. They will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. Allah encourages the believers to spend in His cause, 2)1 xfp. H’j C/j jyj Cp’ jiCJ Cfjfc J P oi f&jj err j t 4And spend of that with which We have provided you before death comes to one of you, and he says: "My Lord! If only You would give me respite for a little while, then I should give Sadaqah from my wealth, and be among the righteous.} Surely, every person who fell into shortcomings will regret it by the time of his death and will ask for respite, even a short period, so that he does better and attains what he missed. No, rather what occurred, has occurred and what is coming, shall indeed come. Each will be held accountable for his mistakes. As for the disbelievers, they will be as Allah said about them, C4 iH vp’ pi Jyj ftA }y_ }And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them; then the wrongdoers will say: "Our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your call and follow the Messengers!" (It will be said) : "Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave."} (14:44), and, L-» U-Xrf Cp jis Cp [**->*-’ 4*- ’i) 7s*~¥ / , >/,» / //• ^ •V’/ * •* A/ Sym Q>J. J iUntil, when death comes to one of them, he says: "My Lord! said me back. So that I may do good in that which I have left behind!" No! It is but a word that he speaks; and behind them is Barzakh (a barrier) until the Day when they will be resurrected.} (23:99-100) Then Allah said; Ip ihij Lf-L.1 "it HiP Aj 5 } And Allah grants respite to none when his appointed time comes. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.}

660 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir meaning, when the time of death comes, no one will be granted respite. Surely, HSe is the Most Knowledgeable and then what they did before. Allah said, 4And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.\$

Surah 64: At-Taghabun

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5963]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAt-Taghabun (Chapter - 64)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah or Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5963–5973]

r nasaiisT . ii In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 4 'y 4 £ tk % &SJI % 'i 1* l&J* }& \$ & U^ & &L 0*# #2 Ut ^^ SE. <j— tfiy 4 ^ iJsJJw*J < ii I' rf*" ..Iff" Ojt* Vj oil pJc iiltj PWwfsoeoeer is in fte heavens and whatsoever is on the earth glorifies Allah. His is the domin- ion, and to Him belongs the praise, and He is Able to do all things.} 42. He it is Who created you, then some ofyou are disbelievers and some of you are believers. And Allah is All-Seer of what you do.} 43. He has created the heavens and the earth with truth, and £0 Cjt utjdl]'j 4)Uc-^i jtjiyljj [y] y&o£3l i^?o-cs

He shaped you and made good your shapes. And to Him is the return.} i4. He knows what is in the heavens and on earth, and He knows what you conceal and what you reveal. And Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat is in the breasts.} Praising Allah and mentioning His Creation and Knowledge This is the last Surah among Al-Musabbihat We mentioned before that all creatures praise the glory of Allah, their Creator and Owner. Allah the Exalted said, iHis is the dominion, and to Him belongs the praise,} meaning, He is the One Who has control over all creation, the One praised for all He created and decreed. Allah's statement, A% t'j-\$& iand He is Able to do all things.} means that whatever He wills occurs without resistance, and whatever He does not will, never occurs. Allah said, U 3si- '(4 jsJi ft iHe it is Who created you, then some of you are disbelievers and some ofyou are believers.} meaning, Allah created you with these characteristics and He willed that for you. Therefore, there will be believers and disbelievers. Surely, Allah is the One Who sees those who deserve guidance and those who deserve misguidance. He is the Witness over His servant's deeds and He will completely recompense them. This is why Allah the Exalted said, A^i-fi Ojfc*-" £j ^j} 4And Allah is All-Seer ofwhat you do.} Allah said, A£\ iHe has created the heavens and the earth with truth,} with equity and wisdom, O'-*-

19Surah 64. At-Taghdbun (5-6) (Part-28) 4and He shaped you and made good your shapes. Hemadeyou in thebestshapesand forms. Allah the Exalted said, 40 man! What has made you careless about your Lord, the most Generous? Who created you, fashioned you perfectly and gave you due proportion; in whateverform He willed. He put you together.) (82:6-8) And His saying, •vp== o— X3S <j& £}i\ ££ csit \$) 4Allah, it is He Who has madefor you the earth as a dwelling place and tire sky as a canopy, and has given you shape and made your shapes good (looking) and has provided you with good

things.) (40:64) and His saying; 4And to Him is the return.) means the return and final destination. Allah then informs of His knowledge of all that there is in the heavens, in the earth and in the souls, He said: 4He knows what is in the heavens and on earth, and He knows what you conceal and what you reveal. And Allah is the All- Knower of what is in the breasts.) JCA& fj £S os oMp jot; cif Ujl> 1£& Gjif.^ ^ 45. Has not the news reached you of those who disbelieved aforetime? And so they tasted the evil result of their disbelief, and theirs will be a painful torment.) 46. That was because there came to them their Messengers with Bayyinat, but they said: "Shall mere men guide us?" So they disbelieved and turned away. But Allah was not in need. And

Allah is not in need, Worthy of all praise.} AWarning delivered through mentioning theEnd ofthe Disbelieving Nations Informing about the past nations and the torment and disciplinary lessons that they suffered because of opposing the Messengers and denying the truth. Allah says; m* & *\$ & % \$ } 4Has not the news reached you of those who disbelieved aforetime?} meaning, information about them and what happened to them, 4'fcA <3£j iAnd so they tasted the evil result of their disbelief. They tasted the evil consequences of their denial and sinful actions. And it refers to the punishment and humiliation they received in the life of the world, iand theirs will be a painful torment.} in the Hereafter, added to the torment they received in this life. Allah explained why; \$That was because there came to them their Messengers with Bayyinat,} supporting arguments, evidence, and clear proofs, \$but they said: "Shall mere men guide us?"} They discounted and dismissed the possibility that the Message would be sent to a human and that their guidance would come by the hands of a man like themselves, 4So they disbelieved and turned away.} they denied the truth and turned away from abiding by it, 4% & \$ > '}

\$But Allah was not in need.} of them, i"rf hf iAnd Allah is not need, Worthy of all praise.} ©S' '4& fj > oj^Ot Cj lifj GJjil CfiK j>l(j <it lr*G» <-£ v^" ife5s» *-^4-* J**y Sy? o*> jy> l^siL Iiii.5 i£T^5 5P^ fcjl % j£V« 47. 77ie disbelievers pretend that they will never be resurrected. Say: "Yes! By my Lord, you will certainly be resurrected, then you will be informed of what you did; and that is easy for Allah."} 45. Therefore, believe in Allah and His Messenger and in the Light which We have sent down. And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.} 49. The Day when He will gather you on the Day of Gathering, that will be the Day of At-Taghabun. And whosoever believes in Allah and performs righteous deeds, He will expiate from him his sins, and will admit him to Gardens beneath which rivers flow, to dwell therein forever; that will be the great success.} 410 . But those who disbelieved and denied Our Aydt, they will be the dwellers of the Fire, to dwell therein forever. And worst indeed is that destination.} Life after Death is True Allah the Exalted informs about the disbelievers, idolators and the atheists that they claim that they will not be resurrected. 1 t' '*K /v •* \ i'frfW f^ 4W dr iSay: "Yes! By my Lord, you will certainly be resurrected, then you will be informed of what you did..."} meaning, "you will be informed of all of your actions, whether major or minor, big or small,"

4<wi*f that is easy for Allah.} 'resurrecting and recompensing you is easy for Allah.' This is the third Ayah in which Allah orders His Messenger 2g to swear by His Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, that Resurrection occurs. The first is in Surah Yunus, «” . •> iAnd they ask you to inform them: "Is it true?" Say: "Yes! By my Lord! It is the very truth! and you can not escape it!"} (10:53), The second is in Surah Saba', t^u ij; J* llils V jx^> Jtij} 4Those who disbelieve say: "The hour will not come to us." Say: "Yes, by my Lord, it will come to you..."} (34:3), and the third is this Ayah, iOU\$\$\$P c>& & '4

4The disbelievers pretend that they will never be resurrected. Say ; "Yes! By my Lord, you will certainly be resurrected, then you will be informed of what you did ; and that is easy for Allah."} Allah the Exalted said, i'<& ts& jPj b\ iTherefore, believe in Allah and in His Messenger and in the Light which We have sent down.} that is, the Qur'an, TJif ojU-> Uj oi'jy 4And Allah is All-Aware of what you do.} none of your deeds ever escapes His knowledge. The Day of At-Taghabun Allah said, 4The Day when He will gather you on the Day of Gathering,}

23Surah 64. At-Taghdbun (7-10) (Part-28 meaning the Day of Resurrection. This is the Day when the earlier and later generations will all be gathered in one area, a caller would be heard by them all, and one's vision would easily see them all. Allah said, iThat is the Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, that is a Day when all will be present.} (11:103), and, iSay : "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. All will surely be gathered together for appointed meeting of a known Day."} (56:49-50) Allah's statement, <5 i that will be the Day of At-Taghabun} Ibn 'Abbas said, "It is one of the names of the Day of Judgement, and that is because the people of Paradise will have gained over the people of the Fire." Qatadah and Mujahid said similarly.*21 Muqatil bin Hayyan said, "There is no mutual loss and gain greater than these entering Paradise and those being taken to the Fire." Allah explained His statement saying; **4^ J-*o ^ S*5; crjb d%> \4 i And whosoever believes in Allah and performs righteous deeds, He will expiate from him his sins, and will admit him to Gardens beneath which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell therein forever; that will be the great success. But those who disbelieved and denied Our Ayat, they will be the dwellers of the Fire, to dwell therein forever. And worst indeed is that 111 At-Tabari 23 :420 121 At-Tabari 23 :419, 420.

destination. We explained these meanings several times before. iCsr & -ir- ot A V& tgjojJifi yjf \$ cs^ ;*& of 5a> if 4^^ ii J*£t 422 . No calamity occurs, but by the permission of Allah, and whosoever believes in Allah, He guides his heart. And Allah is the All-Knower of everything .} 422. Obey Allah, and obey the Messenger; but if you turn away, then the duty of Our Messenger is only to convey clearly.} 423. Allah! La ilaha ila Huwa. And in Allah therefore let the believers put their trust. All that occurs to Mankind is by Allah's Permission Allah informs us as He did in Surut Al-Hadid, y'^r53 4 tj Xj ijyiff <i i . ot •-A-4 4No calamity occurs on the earth or in yourselves but it is inscribed in a record before YJe bring it into existence. Verily, that is easy for Allah. (57:22) Allah said here, 4<if oi 4No calamity occurs, but by the permission of Allah,} Ibn 'Abbas said; "By the command of Allah," meaning from His decree and will. 4.5-4? *if>A fr- i &?. i and whosoever believes in Allah, He guides his heart. And Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} meaning, whoever suffered an affliction and he knew that it occurred by Allah's judgement and decree, and he patiently abides, awaiting Allah's reward, then Allah guides his heart, and will compensate him for his loss in this life by granting

25Surah 64. At-Taghdbun (11-13) (Part-28) guidance to his heart and certainly in faith. Allah will replace whatever he lost for Him with the same or what is better. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas, £. £>} A and whosoever believes in Allah, He guides his heart.} "Allah will guide his heart to certainty. Therefore, he will know that what reached him would not have missed him and what has missed him would not have reached him."I11 There is an agreed upon Hadvth (that Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected and] which states, t'jJ> o'L'J\ td l">. jlf 'iJj Ujti i) Jil V £>•*» "Amazing is the believer: There is no decree that Allah writes for him, but is better for him. If an affliction strikes him,

he is patient and this is better for him. If a bounty is granted to him, he is thankful and this is better for him. This trait is only for the faithful believer,»[21 The Order to obey Allah and His Messenger^ Allah said, 44rtf s y4ff} iObey Allah, and obey the Messenger;} Allah commands obedience to Him and to His Messenger jg in all that His legislates and in implementing His orders. Allah also forbids one from all that His Messenger jg forbids and prohibits. Allah the Exalted said, MA>& c>fi} Abut if you turn away, then the duty of Our Messenger is only to convey clearly.} meaning, 'if you refrain from abiding by the faith, then the Messenger's mission is to convey and your mission is to hear and obey. 'Az-Zuhr! said, "From Allah comes the Message, its m At-Tabari 23:421. 121 Muslim 4:2295.

27 Surah 64. At-Taghabun (14-18) (Part-28) 414. O you who believe! Verily, among your wives and your children there are enemies for you ; therefore beware of them! But if you pardon (them) and overlook, and forgive, then verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. 415. Your wealth and your children are only a Fitnah, whereas Allah! With Him is a great reward. 416. So have Taqwd of Allah as much as you can; listen and obey, and spend in charity; that is better for yourselves. And whosoever is saved from his own greed, then they are the successful ones. 417. If you lend to Allah a handsome loan, He will double it for you, and will forgive you. And Allah is Shakur, Halim, 418. All-Knower of the unseen and seen, the Almighty, the All-Wise.

Warning against the Fitnah of Spouses and Offspring

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5973–5977]

Allah states that some wives and children are enemies to their husbands and fathers, in that they might be busied with them rather than with performing the good deeds. Allah said in another Ayah, j&tiji% py\ \$4 h \p: (S CPU p 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or you children divert you from the remembrance of Allah. And whosoever does that then they are the losers. (63 :9) Allah the Exalted said here, <•^4 4therefore, beware of them!4 for your religion, according to Ibn Zayd. Mujahid explained the Ayah , ijic- pj) Oi ^j\4 4Verily, among your wives and your childreti there are enemies for you ;4 by saying, "They might direct the man to sever his relation or disobey his Lord. The man, who loves his wives and children, might obey them in this case." Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that

28 TafsTr Ibn Kathxr Ibn 'Abbas said to a man who asked him about this Ayah, 40 you who believe! Verily, among your wives and your children there are enemies for you ; therefore beware of them!) "There were men who embraced Islam in Makkah and wanted to migrate to Allah's Messenger sg\$. However, their wives and children refused to allow them. Later when they joined Allah's Messenger 3^5 , they found that those who were with him (the Companions) have gained knowledge in the religion, so they were about to punish their wives and children. Allah the Exalted sent down this Ayah, \> .vs \>.*c \yuo« d£) iBut if you pardon (them) and overlook, and forgive, then verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.)" At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadth and said that it is Hasan SahOi) Allah's statement, x\) iYour wealth and your children are only a Fintah, whereas Allah! With Him is a great reward.) Allah said that the wealth and children are a test and trial from Allah the Exalted for His creatures, so that He knows those who obey Him and those who disobey Him. Allah's statement, 4whereas Allah! With Him) meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, %) iis a great reward.) As Allah said; }'Md\ Jgifo oOfj **lif dJ. c£) % gif sgs ££ jgax gsm&& fisfW£3f iii TuhfatAl-Ahwardhi9 :222

29 Surah 64. At-Taghdbun (14-18) (Part-28) 4 Beautified for men is the love of things they covet; women children, Qanatir Al-Muqantarrah™ of gold and silver, branded beautiful horses, cattle and well-tilled land. This is the pleasure of the present world's life; but Allah has the excellent return with him.} (3:14), and the Ayah after it. Imam Ahmad recorded that Buraydah said, "The Messenger of Allah jg was giving a speech and Al-Hasan and Husayn came in wearing red shirts, walking and tripping. The Messenger ;g descended from the Minbar, held them and placed them in front of them and said, cJliu I "Allah and His Messenger said the truth, 'Verily, your wealth and your children are a Fitnah. I saw these two boys walking and tripping and could not be patient until I stopped my speech and picked them up .a"121 This was recorded by the Sunan compilers, and At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Ghaiib.",3t The Order for Taqwa, as much as One is Capable Allah said, iSo have Taqwa of Allah as much as you can;} meaning, as much as you are able and can bear or endure. The Two SahXhs recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah 5g said, l•o L lib *When I command you to do something, do as much as you can of it, and whatever I forbid for you, then avoid ff.nl41 Allah's statement, [1] See volume two, the Tafstrot Surah At 'ImnSn (3 :14). Ahmad 5:354. 131 Abu Dawud 1:663, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10:278, An-Nasal 3:108, Ibn Majah 2 :1 190. Fath Al-B&ri 13 :264 , Muslim 2 :975

4listen and obey,') means, obey what Allah and His Messenger jg command you to do and do not stray from it to the right or left. Do not utter a statement or make a decision before Allah and His Messenger issue a statement or decision. Do not ignore what you were ordered to do, nor commit what you were forbidden from doing. Encouraging Charity Allah the Exalted said, iand spend in charity; that is betterfor yourselves.} meaning, give from what Allah has granted you to your relatives, the poor, the needy and the weak. Be kind to Allah's creatures, just as Allah was and still is kind with you. This will be better for you in this life and the Hereafter. Otherwise, if you do not do it, it will be worse for you in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said; 4And whosoever is savedfrom his own greed, then they are the successful ones.} This was explained with a similar Ayah in Surat Al-Hashr, where we also mentioned the relevant Hadiths Therefore, we do not need to repeat them here, all praise and gratitude is due to Allah. Allah the Exalted said, 4p -ft ^ o[] ilf you lend to Allah a handsome loan, He will double it for you, and willforgive you.} meaning, whatever you spend, then Allah will replace it, and on Him will be the reward of whatever you give away in charity. Allah considered giving charity as if it is a loan to Him, just as Allah said in a Qudsi Hadith, lil See volume nine, the Tafsir of SuratAl-Hashr (59 :9)

V-4* Vj 'fA y> <<"Who will give a loan to He Who is neither unjust nor poor?">>[1] This is why Allah the Exalted said in Surat Al-Baqarah, 4*j (iUiS li! iSo that He may multiply it to him many times (2:245) Allah said; }and willforgive you.} meaning, He will erase your mistakes, }And Allah is Shakur} meaning, He gives abundantly in return for what was little, iHalim} means, He forgives, pardons, covers and absolves the sins, mistakes, errors and shortcomings, i'\$r.iS3S jipi\j jE\ iAll-Knoiver of the unseen and seen, the Almighty, the All-Wise.} Its explanation has already preceded several times.

Surah 65: At-Talaq

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 5978]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat At-Talaq (Chapter - 65)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5978–5994]

ooA jij^ poa, > *>' .“T^< "/"inf > -V V^ DLy*^4j -4 « #jMUWa^ ^j^ot o-icr In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. jOi £& i-j Q\ slit ^1) &&U v it ijiitj .1 v/i ;•»£ <t' - » ' <J* *1 J > » - v !*“i - < .< ' .f tyJU cJahj jS-^r4 tLA^u /'/' JUI <ul JJ-U- JUm ^j 4U1 iit £j ^Jg * jL* pi 4y5£*t i<ij'i jui ^2. O Prophet! When you divorce women, di- vorce them at their Td- dah and count their ‘Iddah. And have Taqwa of Allah, your Lord. And turn them not out of their homes nor slmll they leave, except in case they are guilty of Fahishah Mubayyinah. And those are the set limits ofAllah. And whosoever transgresses the set limits of Allah, then indeed he has wronged himself. You know not, it may be that Allah will afterward bring some new thing to pass.}

33Surah 65. At-Talaq (1) (Part-28) There is aPeriod duringwhich DivorcedWomen remain in TheirHomes The Prophet jg was addressed first in this Ayah, to honor him, even though his Ummah is also being addressed in Allah's statement, 40 Prophet! When you divorce women, divorce them at their •Iddah» Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘Abdullah bin TJmar divorced his wife, during the lifetime of Allah’s Messenger jg, while she was menstruating. TJmar bin Al-Khattab mentioned that to Allah’s Messenger jg. Allah’s Messenger became angiy and said, 1 IjjUai j I IjJ i;4kj fc j~>~ If^r.1!" y- 4)1 I4; oJLmJI <2lki 1 If.-w jl Jj LfJ&llapj “Order him to take her back and keep her until she is clean from her menses, and then to wait until she gets her next period and becomes clean again. Then, if he wishes to divorce her, he can divorce her when she is clean from her menses, before he has sexual intercourse with her. This is the ‘Iddah which Allah the Exalted and Most Honored Iwsfixed.»[1] Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in several parts of his Sahih. Muslim collected this Hadithand his narration uses these words, Jl If) jILj ji 4)1 f\ oJutii kilbjl “This is the ‘Iddah which Allah has fixed for the women being divorced.»2) In his Sahih, Muslim has recorded a Hadith which is a more appropriate version from a narration of Ibn Jurayj who said that Abu Az-Zubayr informed him that he heard ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Ayman, the freed slave of ‘Azzah, questioning .‘Abdullah bin TJmar. And Abu Az-Zubayr heard the question, “What about a man who divorces his wife while she is still on her menses?” ‘Abdullah answered, “During the time of Allah’s 111 Fath Al-B&ri 8:521. 121 Fath Al-B&ri9 :258 , 393 ; Muslim 2 :1094 , 1095

35Siirah 65. At-Taldq (1) (Part-28) clear that she is pregnant, or he does not due to having sex, or since he does not know if she is pregnant or not. This is why the scholars said that there are two types of divorce, one that conforms to the Sunnah and another innovated. The divorce that conforms to the Sunnah is one where the husband pronounces one divorce to his wife when she is not having her menses and without having had sexual intercourse with her after the menses ended. One could divorce his wife when it is clear that she is pregnant. As for the innovated divorce, it occurs when one divorces his wife when she is having her menses, or after the menses ends, has sexual intercourse with her and then divorces her, even though he does not know if she became pregnant or not. There is a third type of divorce, which is neither a Sunnah nor an innovation where one divorces a young wife who has not begun to have menses, the wife who is beyond the age of having menses, and divorcing one's wife before the marriage was consummated. Allah said, 4;lii \f^j} } and count their 'Iddah meaning, count for it and know its beginning and end, so that the 'Iddah does not become prolonged for the woman and she cannot get married again, 4|^=vj } And have Taqwd of Allah, your Lord.} in this matter. Spending and Housing is up to the Husband during the Revocable 'Iddah Period Allah said, 4And turn than not out of their homes nor shall they leave,} meaning, during the duration of the 'Iddah, she has the right to housing from her husband, as long as the 'Iddah period continues. Therefore, the husband does not have the right to force her out of her house, nor is she allowed to leave his house, because she is still tied to the marriage contract. Allah said,

pcfc ^%} } iexcept in case they are guilty ofFahishah Mubayyinah.} meaning that the divorced wife is not to abandon her husband's house unless she commits Fahishah Mubayyinah, in which case, she vacates her husband's house. For example, Fahishah Mubayyinah implies adultery, according to 'Abdullah bin Mas'fld, Ibn 'Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Ash-ShaTai, Al- Hasan, Ibn Sirin, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Qilabah, Abu Salih, Ad-Dahhak, Zayd bin Aslam, 'Ata' Al- Khurasani, As-Suddi, Said bin Hilal and others. * Fahishah Mubayyinah implies disobeying her husband openly or when she abuses her husband's family in words and actions, according to Ubay bin Ka'b, Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah and others.'2 ' Allah's statement, yji &j} 4And those are the set limits ofAllah.} means, these are from His legislation and prohibitions, i •(* ** •"1 Jjj- ir-jf 4And whosoever transgresses the set limits ofAllah,} meaning, whoever violates these limits, transgresses them and implements anything else besides them, '&*} 4then indeed he has wronged himself.} by doing so. TheWisdom of *Iddah at the Husband's House Allah said, 4{X <iU'iM y} 4You know not, it may be that Allah will afterward bring some new thing to pass.} meaning, *We commanded that the divorced wife remains in her husband's house during the 'Iddah period, so that the l1 ' At-Tabari 23:438, Al-Qurfubi 18:156, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :194 I2' AMabari 23:438.

37Surah 65 . At-Talaq () (Part-28) husband might regret his action and Allah decides that the husband feels in his heart for the marriage to continue.' This way, returning to his wife will be easier for him. Az-Zuhri said that Tjbaydullah bin 'Abdullah said that Fatimah bint Qays said about Allah's statement, ^You know not, it may be that Allah will afterward bring some new thing to pass.) "Taking her back."111 Similar was said by Ash-Shalji, 'Ata', Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Ath-Thawri.'21 The IrrevocablyDivorcedWoman does not have a Right to Provisions andAccommodations from the Husband Here the view of the scholars of the Salaf and those who follow them is that housing is not obligatory in the case of the irrevocably divorced woman. They also relied on the Hadith of

Fatimah bint Qays Al-Fihriyah when her husband Abu 'Amr bin Hafs divorced her the third and fined time. He was away from her in Yemen at the time, and he sent her his decision to divorce her. He also sent some barley with his messenger, but she did not like the amount or method of compensation. He said, "By Allah I am not obligated to spend upon you." So, she went to Allah's Messenger sg, who said, "There is no obligation on him to spend on you." Muslim added in his narration, «nor housing.» And he ordered her to finish her 'Iddah period in the house of Umm Shank. He then said, "She is a woman my Companions visit. Spend this period in the house." At-Tabari 23:441. At-Tabari 23 : 442 Al-Qurfubi 18 :157 , Ad-DurrAl-McmthOr8 :194

39 Surah 65. At-Talaq (2-3) (Part-28) divorced wife if he can return to her. If she is not permitted for him anymore, until she marries another husband, then he does not have to provide her with spending and housing.¹¹ An-Nasal also recorded this narration.¹²¹ % JJc liji Ojyi-J C&Afi \$ OiW' 6*1; ij jZZ ifll gZ cf'j jff\$} 4i\ Cyfit O? i>* hfjj ^=4'i ji, Jti Alii oj. riili. <E' J® j^i I>y ^ jj ,£\$l&3^ 42. Then when they are about to attain their term appointed, either take them back in a good manner or part with them in a good manner. And take as witness two just persons from among you . And establish the testimony for Allah . That will be an admonition given to him who believes in Allah and the Last Day. And whosoever has Taqwd of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out> 43. And He will provide him from where he never could imagine. And whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him. Verily, Allah will accomplish his purpose. Indeed Allah has set a measure for all things Ordaining Kindness towards Divorced Women Allah the Exalted says that when the woman who is in her 'Iddah nears the end of the 'Iddah term, the husband must decide to reconcile with her, thus keeping their marriage together, 4in a good manner while being kind to her in their companionship. Otherwise, he must decide to divorce her on good terms, without abusing, cursing, or admonishing her. To the contrary, he should divorce her on good terms, observing kindness and good manners. 111 At-Tabarani in Al-Kabir²⁴ :382 121 An-Nasal 6 :144

The Command to have Witnesses for the Return Allah said, dlji 4And take as witness two just persons from among you> meaning when taking her back, if this is your decision. Abu Dawud and Ibn Majah recorded that Imran bin Husayn was asked about a man who divorced his wife and then had sexual intercourse with her, without notifying witnesses of when he divorced her and when he took her back. Imran said, "His divorce and taking her back was in contradiction to the Sunnah. Incorporate the presence of witnesses for divorcing her and taking her back, and do not repeat your conduct." Ibn Jurayj said that 'Ata' commented on the Ayah, 4And take as witness two just persons from among you "It is not permissible to marry, divorce or take back the divorced wife except with two just witnesses, just as Allah the Exalted has said, except when there is a valid excuse." Allah's statement, 4^5' 6jj> bf & 'it Jifrijj 4That will be an admonition given to him who believes in Allah and the Last Day.} means, "this, Our command to you to have witnesses in such cases and to establish the witness, is implemented by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day.' This legislation is meant to benefit those who fear Allah's punishment in the Hereafter. Allah provides, suffices, and makes a Way out of Every Hardship for Those Who have Tctqwc Allah said, '4£ i j3 ft <£ 4And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way far Abu Dfiwud 2 :637, Ibn Majah 1 :652.

41 Surah 65. At-Taldq (2-3) (Part-28 him to get out. And He will provide him from where he never could imagine . meaning, whoever has Taqwa of Allah in what He has commanded and avoids what He has forbidden, then Allah will make a way out for him from every difficulty and will provide for him from resources he never anticipated or thought about. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas‘ud said, “The most comprehensive Ayah in the Qur’an is, iVerily, Allah enjoins Al-‘Adl (justice) and Al-Ilisan (doing good} (16:90). The greatest Ayah in the Qur’an that contains relief is, Si’ igt ifof} 4And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out.}” ‘Ikrimah also commented on the Ayah, “Whoever divorces as Allah commanded him, then Allah will make a way out for him.”¹¹¹ Similar was reported from Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak. ‘Abdullah bin Mas‘Qd and Masrpq commented on the Ayah, 4C£, i&&& Jj} 4And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out.} “It pertains to when one knows that if Allah wills He gives, and ifHe wills He deprives, ifrom where he never could imagine.} from resources he did not anticipate”^{*21} Qatadah said, 4And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out.} “meaning, from every doubt and the horrors experienced at the At-Tabari 23:446. ^{*21} At-Tabari 23:445, 446.

time of death, iAnd He will provide him from where he never could imagine} from where he never thought of or anticipated.”¹¹¹ Allah said. '>' if -I" Vi" jHp Jill Jc J4j} iAnd whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him.} Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said that he rode the Prophet’s camel while sitting behind the Prophet igj, and the Messenger of Allah said to him, a-L>u 2)1 Jaa^l i . MUL-w., Uj^l * ., “j l ^K .M ’ 1 i ^ | \JD ol ijiii li oc!>l lilj i SjI jLili oJL. tiJ3 jij niU ji ;,— VI ij^Aali »>. j>i .^ ll oa>- j ^^AiSfl oJ2j ijillt 2)1 <3? jJ Vj hj'jj£ «0 boy! I will teach you words [so learn them]. Be mindful of Allah and He will protect you, be mindful ofAllah and He will be on your side. If you ask, ask Allah, and if you seek help, seek it from Allah. Know that if the Ummah gather their strength to bring you benefit, they will never bring you benefit, except that which Allah has decreed for you . Know that if they gather their strength to harm you, they will never harm you, except with that which Allah has decreed against you . The pens have been raised and the pages are dry.» At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadth and said: “Hasan Sahuh.’^ Allah’s statement, iVerily, Allah will accomplish his purpose.} meaning, Allah will execute His decisions and judgement that He made for him, in whateverway He wills and chooses, Af-Tabari 23:448. 121 Ahmad 1 :293. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :219

43 Surah 65. At-Talaq (4-5) (Part-28) toil jl>. ilnedeed Allah has set a measurefor all things.} This is like His saying: „x*CO pXSr faV iEverything with Him is in (due) proportion .} (13:8) S^= -3 <4^5 y4^ or- ^ i>l OJ <>-£ ^ iu> J3.&\$ c£ S* ol#3 J>Vf lijij 4@\$ jiiij 1^2} •A'v* 1^ . «>*J ^2)^ 44. Those in menopause among your women , for them the ‘Iddah, ifyou have doubt, is three months; and for those who have no courses . And for those who are pregnant, their ‘Iddah is until they lay down their burden; and whosoever has Taqwa ofAllah, He will make his matter easyfor him.} 45. That is the command ofAllah, which He has sent down to you ; and whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will expiate from him his sins, and will increase his reward.} The *Iddah ofThose in Menopause and Those Who do not have Menses Allah the Exalted clarifies the waiting period of the woman in menopause. And that is the one whose menstruation has stopped due to her older age. Her ‘Iddah is three months instead of the three monthly cycles for those who menstruate, which is based upon the Ayah in (Surat) Al-Baqarah. (see 2:228] The same for the^young, who have not reached the years of menstruation. Their ‘Iddah is three months like those in menopause. This is the meaning of His saying; i Jij} iandfbr those who have no

courses...} as for His saying; 4i?i0 ifyou have doubt. . .} There are two opinions: First, is the saying of a group of the Salaf, like Mujahid, Az-

44 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Zuhn and Ibn Zayd. That is, if they see blood and there is doubt if it was menstrual blood or not.*11 The second, is that if you do not know the ruling in this case, then know that their 'Iddah is three months. This has been reported from Said bin Jubayr and it is the view preferred by Ibn JarirJ2 And this is the more obvious meaning. Supporting this view is what is reported131 from Ubay bin Ka*b that he said, "O Allah's Messenger! Some women were not mentioned in the Qur'an, the young, the old and the pregnant." Allah the Exalted and Most Honored sent down this Ayah, ol o£ J*i*3 bt iay J>VfM iThose in menopause among your women, for them the 'Iddah, ifyou have doubt, is three months; and for those who have no courses. And for those who are pregnant, their 'Iddah is until they lay down their burden .^'41 Ibn Abi Hitim recorded a simpler narration than this one from Ubay bin Ka*b who said, "O Allah's Messenger! When the Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah was revealed prescribing the 'Iddah of divorce, some people in Al-Madlnah said, There are still some women whose Iddah has not been mentioned in the Qur'an. There are the young, the old whose menstruation is discontinued, and the pregnant.' Later on, this Ayah was revealed, 2 brXb ol o£ ot iThose in menopause among your women, for them the 'Iddah, ifyou have doubt, is three months; and for those who have no courses.p*Si At-Jabari 23:450. At-Jabari 23:452. I3| This and the following are reported from him by 'Amr bin Salim, who it is said did not actually hear from Ubay, rendering the narrations Mursal. At-Jabari 23:451. Al-HSkm 2:492.

45Surah 65. At-Taldq (4-5) (Part-28) *Iddah ofPregnantWomen Allah's statement, 4 l>4&- 4And for those who are pregnant, their 'Iddah is until they lay down their burden Allah says: the pregnant woman's 'Iddah ends when she gives birth, whether in the case of divorce or death of the husband, according to the agreement of the majority of scholars of the Salaf and later generations. This is based upon this honorable Ayah and what is mentioned in the Prophetic Sunnah. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Salamah said, "A man came to Ibn 'Abbas while Abu Hurayrah was sitting with him and said, 'Give me your verdict regarding a lady who delivered a baby forty days after the death of her husband.' Ibn 'Abbas said,' [Her Iddah period lasts until) the end of the longest among the two prescribed periods.' I recited, 4For those who are pregnant, their prescribed period is until they deliver their burdens Abu Hurayrah said, 1 agree with my cousin (Abu Salamah).' Then Ibn 'Abbas sent his slave Kurayb to Umm Salamah to ask her. She replied, The husband of Subay'ah Al-Aslamiyyah was killed while she was pregnant, and she delivered a baby forty days after his death. Then she received a marriage proposal and Allah's Messenger jg married her to somebody. Abu As-Sanabil was one of those who proposed to her.'" Al- Bukhari collected this short form of the Hadith, which Muslim and other scholars of Hadith collected using its longer form. Imam Ahmad recorded that Al-Miswar bin Makhramah said, "Subay'ah Al-Aslamiyyah gave birth to a child a few days after the death of her husband. When she finished the postdeliveiy term, she was proposed to. So she sought the permission of Allah's Messenger jg for the marriage, and he permitted her to 111 FathAl-Bari 8:521. 121 Falh Al-Bari 9 :379 , Muslim 2 : 1 123 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 4 :375 , An- Nasal 6 :192

marry, so she got married."111 Al-Bukhari collected this narration, as did Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah121 with a different chain of narration from the Hadith of Subay'ah. Muslim bin

Al-Hajjaj recorded that Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah bin Utbah said that his father wrote to Umar bin ‘Abdullah bin Al-Arqam Az-Zuhn, requesting that he go to Subay'ah bint Al-Harith Al-Aslamiyyah to ask her about the matter in question, and about what Allah’s Messenger ﷺ said to her when she sought his verdict. Umar bin ‘Abdullah wrote to Ubaydullah bin ‘Abdullah bin Utbah informing him that Subay'ah told him that she had been married to Sa’d bin Khawlah, and he was one of those who participated in the battle of Badr. He died during the Farewell Pilgrimage, while she was pregnant. Soon after his death, she gave birth. When she passed the postnatal term, she beautified herself for those who might propose to her. Abu As-Sanabil bin Bakak came to her and said, *Why do I see you have beautified yourself? Do you wish to remarry? By Allah, you cannot marry unless four months and ten days have passed.” Subay'ah said, “When he said that, I dressed myself in the evening and went to Allah’s Messenger and asked him about his verdict. He gave me a religious verdict that I was allowed to marry after I had given birth to my child, saying I could marry if I wish.”¹³¹ This is the narration that Muslim collected. Al-Bukhari collected this Hadith in a shorter form.¹⁴¹ Allah’s statement, ¹⁴ *And whoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make his matter easy for him.* means, Allah will make his matters lenient for him and will [1) Ahmad 4:327. 121 Fath Al-Bari 9:379, 7:360, Abu Dawud 2:728, An-Nasal 6:190,196, Ibn Majah 1 :654. Muslim no. 1122. Fath Al-Bari 9:379.

47 Surah 65. At-Talaq (6-7) (Part-28) swam 0# 'mmm %i cfcf}Crg^ * j^jilJ <£H SJO-^0 ^oiofe\$ C^r^S^AS \>'S fcCctMufcty i jtr. '*s . f \s~" -iff •> soon bring forth relief and a quick way out, 4 ^ >4'j^ 477iaf is the command of Allah, which He has sent down to you;} meaning, this is His commandment and legislation that He sent down to you through His Messenger ﷺ, -ffcf i* ~j& iii jti o*J^ 4£^ A (*^J 4 and whoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will expiate from him his sins, and will increase his reward.) means, Allah will prevent what he fears and multiply his reward even for the little good he does. !M&S £* of, iff i^J '(J& of, cij/tf ff \>jf> cfjy^ o*~\$ o} oiii- cj*^“ <S*“ Ot? ill iili it; fjj Jji 0*J •5s*-' Oi >>- jj A f^A-i 40£i^ JW iat fct: H^ lit V 46. Lodge them where you dwell, according to what you have, and do not harm them so as to suppress them . And if they are pregnant, then spend on them till they lay down their burden. Then if they suckle the children far you, give them their due payment, and let each of you deal with each other in a mannerly way. But if you make difficulties far one another, then some other woman may suckle far him.)

i7 Let the rich man spend according to his means; and the man whose resources are restricted, let him spend according to what Allah has given him. Allah puts no burden on any person beyond what He has given him. Allah will grant after hardship, ease.) The Divorced Woman has the Right to Decent Accommodations, what is Reasonable Allah the Exalted orders His faithful servants that when one of them divorces his wife, he should provide housing for her until

the end of her ‘Iddah period,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 5994–6002]

i Lodge them where you dwell, means, with you, ifej i according to what you have,) Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and several others said, it refers to “Your ability.”¹¹¹ Qatadah said, “If you can only afford to accommodate her in a corner of your house, then do so.”¹²¹ .#er bidding Ill-Treatment of Divorced Women Allah’s statement, i and do not harm them in order to suppress them.) Muqatil bin

Hayyan said, “meaning, do not annoy her to force her to pay her way out nor expel her from your house.” Ath- Thawri said from Mansur, from Abu Ad-Duha: ^ %) iand do not harm them in order to suppress them) “He divorces her, and when a few days remain, he tak-pg her back.”¹³¹ At-Tabari 23:457. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur⁸ :207 Al-Qurtubi 18:168.

50 Tafslr Ibn Kathir in a just way without causing harm to either one of them, just as Allah the Exalted said in Surat Al-Baqarah, \$ "Jj* "3} 4No mother shall be treated unfairly on account of her child, norfather on account ofchild.} (2:233) Allah said, 4But if you make difficulties for one another, then some other woman may sucklefor him.} meaning, if the divorced couple disagrees, because the woman asks for an unreasonable fee for suckling their child, and the father refuses to pay the amount or offers an unreasonable amount, he may find another woman to suckle his child. If the mother agrees to accept the amount that was to be paid to the woman who agreed to suckle the child, then she has more right to suckle her own child. Allah’s statement, 4Let the rich man spend according to his means;} means, the wealthy father or his representative should spend on the child according to his means, u "i) ili ill liKi ill ibi; Hi iand the man whose resources are restricted, let him spend according to what Allah has given him. Allah puts no burden on any person beyond what He has given him.} This is as Allah said, C-i & - i&i "S}> ^Allah does not burden a person beyond what He can bear.} [2:286] A Story ofaWomanwho had Taqwa Allah’s statement; iAllah will grant after hardship, ease.}

52Surah 65. At-Talaq (6-7) (Part-28) This is a sure promise from Him, and indeed, Allah’s promises are true and He never breaks them, This is an Allah’s saying; •>:? « J. «*{f " ?,fV 4Verily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief. [94:5-6] There is a relevant Hadth that we should mention here. Imam Ahmad recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, “A man and his wife from an earlier generation were poor. Once when the man came back from a journey, he went to his wife saying to her, while feeling hunger and fatigued, ‘Do you have anything to eat?’ She said, “Yes, receive the good news of Allah’s provisions.’ He again said to her, If you have anything to eat, bring it to me.’ She said, “Wait a little longer.’ She was awaiting Allah’s mercy. When the matter was prolonged, he said to her, ‘Get up and bring me whatever you have to eat, because I am real hungry and fatigued.’ She said, “I will. Soon I will open the oven’s cover, so do not be hasty.’ When he was busy and refrained from insisting for a while, she said to herself, *1 should look in my oven.’ So she got up and looked in her oven and found it full of the meat of a lamb, and her mortar and pestle was full of seed grains; it was crushing the seeds on its own. So, she took out what was in the mortar and pestle, after shaking it to remove everything from inside, and also took the meat out that she found in the oven.” Abu Hurayrah added, “By He in Whose Hand is the life of Abu Al-Qasim (Prophet Muhammad jsg)! This is the same statement that Muhammad ssg said, ayOji ^)j U oiij jt tHad she taken out what was in her mortar and not emptied it fully by shaking it, it wotdd have continued crushing the seeds until the Day ofResurrection . »”¹ 1 I 1 1 Ahmad 2:421. There is a similar version no. 10663. Both chains have disparaged narrators. Most of the scholars indicated its weakness

52 Tafslr Ibn Kathir cjUi ^5(^2 6jc Cf-ij U<Ai (jff aft 4jk it i£u &£ ^ it il @£i iy^& i^l jg !A* *|t£3 9^ if v4>: j& £* -ja it3 i fee I>i Cf J? 9“*” ii^jj UiXtf j-uu> jit £,*£ jlJill Jj jj liijiSji l&j ?! iif o-^ Ji bJ tjjj cyyji 3&i 4S. And many a town revolted against the command of its Lord and His Messengers; and We ca//ed it to a severe account, and We shall punish it with a horrible torment. \$9. So it tasted the evil

result of its affair, and the consequence of its affair was loss 430. Allah has prepared for them a severe torment. So have Taqwa of Allah, O men of understanding, those who believe! Allah has indeed sent down to you a Reminder.} meaning, they tasted the evil consequences of defiance and they regretted their actions when regret does not avail, p.10 & added the consequence of its affair was loss. And Allah has prepared for them a severe torment.} means, in the Hereafter, added to the torment that was sent down on them in this life. Allah the Exalted said, after mentioning what happened to the disbelieving nations, 4{ } meaning, 'O you who have sound understanding, do not be like them because if you do, you will suffer what they suffered, O people of comprehension,' who believe} meaning, in Allah and His Messengers, 4{ } meaning, this Qur'an. Allah also said, <{ }! © £4 iVerily, We, it is We Who have sent down the Dhikr and surely. We will preserve it.} (15:9) The Qualities of the Messenger^ Allah's statement, 4A Messenger, who recites to you the Ayat of Allah containing clear explanations,} Some said that the Messenger is the subject of what is being sent [as a reminder] because the Messenger is the one that

conveys the Dhikr. Ibn Jarir said that what is correct is that the Messenger explains the Dhikr^ This is why Allah the Exalted said here. 4p2 & ip} 4A Messenger, who recites to you the Ayat of Allah containing clear explanations, meaning, plain and apparent. The statement of Allah; 4YP ji u \& p: 'S&& it that He may take out those who believe and do righteous good deeds, from the darkness to the light. Allah's is like saying; \ U o-k yii 4^4=*^ 4A Book which We have revealed unto you in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness} (14:1), and, <Jl Cri tlj iAllah is the Guardian of those who believe. He brings them out from darkness into light.} (2:257) meaning, out of the darkness of disbelief and ignorance into the light of faith and knowledge. Allah the Exalted called the revelation that He has sent down, light, on account of the guidance that it brings. Allah also called it f?uh, in that, it brings life to the hearts, Uy sf; P&s IX c \J & cx Ml P4 <%*%} Of "ki ijXr 4And thus We have sent to you Rith of our command. You knew not what is the book, nor what is faith? But We have made it a light wherewith we guide whosoever of Our servants We will. And verily, you are indeed guiding to the straight path.} (42:52) Allah's statement, IM At-Tabari 23 :468

53Surah 65. At-Talacj (8-11) (Part-28) meaning, horrendous and terrifying, 4So it tasted the evil result of its affair,} meaning, they tasted the evil consequences of defiance and they regretted their actions when regret does not avail, p.10 & added the consequence of its affair was loss. And Allah has prepared for them a severe torment.} means, in the Hereafter, added to the torment that was sent down on them in this life. Allah the Exalted said, after mentioning what happened to the disbelieving nations, 4{ } meaning, 'O you who have sound understanding, do not be like them because if you do, you will suffer what they suffered, O people of comprehension,' who believe} meaning, in Allah and His Messengers, 4{ } meaning, this Qur'an. Allah also said, <{ }! © £4 iVerily, We, it is We Who have sent down the Dhikr and surely. We will preserve it.} (15:9) The Qualities of the Messenger^ Allah's statement, 4A Messenger, who recites to you the Ayat of Allah containing clear explanations,} Some said that the Messenger is the subject of what is being sent [as a reminder] because the Messenger is the one that

55Surah 65. At-Talacj (12) (Part-28) JiQ ijy oyj£ 'j£fi 1 ^ o' Ji Sf 4A«d whosoever believes in Allah and performs righteous good deeds, He will admit him into Gardens under which rivers flow, to dwell

therein forever. Allah has indeed granted for him an excellent provision.} was explained several times before, and therefore, we do not need to repeat its explanation here. All the thanks and praises are due to Allah. }isr&& 'Jr* Jjk 04 uifh o*J csjf ST> ^12. /f is Allah Who has created seven heavens and of the earth the like thereof. His command descends between them, that you may know that Allah has power over all things, and that Allah surrounds all things with (His) knowledge.} Allah's Perfect Power Allah the Exalted asserts His perfect power and infinite greatness, so that the great religion that He has legislated is honored and implemented, 4^*5" %a} 4It is Allah Who has created seven heavens} Allah said in similar Ayat, like what Prophet Nuh said to his people, iSee you not how Allah has created the seven heavens one above another?} (71:15), and, iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify him.} (17:44) Allah's statement, T^} iand of the earth the like thereof.} means, He created seven earths. In theTwo SahOis, there is a Hadith that states,

56 Tafstr Ibn Kathir <4- <lr? ilrf 4-? .y "lATwyer usurps the land of somebody unjustly, even if it was a mere hand span, then his neck will be encircled with it down to the seven earths .«,1! And in SahOi Al-Bukhari the wording is: f iJ\ v...he will sink down to the seven earths .»121 In the beginning of my book, Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah, I mentioned the various narrations for this Hadith when I narrated the story of the creation of the earth . 131 All the thanks and praise is due to Allah. Those who explained this Hadith to mean the seven continents have brought an implausible explanation that contradicts the letter of the Qur'an and the Hadith without having proof.

Surah 66: At-Tahrim

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The Tafsir of Surat At-Tahrim

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6003–6023]

(Chapter - 66) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah oV ^ C + ^ t*, / ^ X \C , "T'tj- ' •'. '? ' sr?'* UIJ «*•>jJi3<U ill 5il5^ U-j^ItalJlJ 0\i^L>te-C- I^tv' <*&% < ^ A'r'" ->^T> \$Sjhsffi:a^ffHujSv!#y In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. iii jl3 £ jj q&> •Sfx t' /. * * * ,, *2 "Vij iiU-li)* ^aij dll 'Q iill ,_£> Jj jf % % pk u & P % fr^&S f® °*0 ££ -4~ljJ J? jl J^e- iit .*> ciili -4j life; llii jLp\$ M ui jfci ^ & & j> # 4 !/f^" o!^ LSojU c.'»g >i,-" -i • - >,t" -> ,:r i,r (4^y 4/fj 4* y> -o' 4 M 'jZ 1^135 ^if c£-&* 4 i>-* '4».a4 <®»£ <*&£ ^ (3^ o' ^2. O Prophet! Why do you forbid that which Allah luis allowed to you, seeking to please your wives? And Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.> i2 . Allah has already ordained for you (O men) the absolution

58 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir from your oaths. And Allah is your Protector and He is the All-Knower, the All-Wise.} ^3. And (remember) when the Prophet disclosed a matter in confidence to one of his wives, then she told it. And Allah made it known to him; he informed part thereof and left a part. Then when he told her thereof, she said: "Who told you this?" He said: "The All-Knower, the All-Aware has told me."} 44. If you two turn in repentance to Allah, your hearts are indeed so inclined; but if you help one another against him, then verily, Allah is his Protector, and fibril, and the righteous among the believers; and after that the angels are his helpers.} 45. Maybe his Lord, if he divorces you, will give him instead of you, wives better than you - submitting, believers, obedient, turning to Allah in repentance, worshipping Allah sincerely, Sa'ihat, previously married, and virgins.} Allah censures His Prophet jg for Prohibiting Himself from what He has allowed for Him In the Book of Vows, Al-Bukhari recorded that Tjbayd bin 'Umayr said that he heard 'A'ishah claiming that Allah's Messenger jg used to stay for a period in the house of Zaynab bint Jahsh and drink honey in her house. (She said) "Hafsah and I decided that when the Prophet 2g entered upon either of us, we would say, 1 smell Maghafi^ on you. Have you eaten Maghafir?' When he entered upon one of us, she said that to him. He replied (to her), «AJ Jilp 'k-Z- olp j; *No, but I drank honey in the house of Zaynab bint Jahsh, and I will never drink it again.*" Then the following was revealed; && z& 2& 40 Prophet! Why do you fobid that which Allah has allowed to you?} up to, 4(&tji -*i»\$ JI Xjl The author explains below.

ilfyou both turn in repentance to Allah, your hearts are indeed so inclined;} in reference to 'A'ishah and Hafsah. o"; iAnd (remember) when the Prophet disclosed a matter in confidence to one of his wives,} which refers to this saying, * . > , ' • <*&But I have drunk honey Ibrahim bin Musa said that Hisham said that it also meant his saying, ® jJJ a] ,5ytf\ J «/ will not drink it anymore, I have taken an oath to that. Therefore, do not inform anybody about if.®' Al-Bukhari also recorded this Hadith in the Book of Divorce;12' then he said, " Al-Maghafir is a type of sap, and in Ar-Rimth (a type of citrus) its taste is

sweet...” Al-Jawhan said, “The ‘f/r/ut’ is a tree of the shrub variety, which secretes Maghfur.” Muslim collected this Hadith from ‘A’ishah in the Book of Divorce in his SahO, and his wording is the same as Al- Bukhari in the Book of Vows.’⁴ In the Book of Divorce, Al-Bukhari recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “Allah’s Messenger ^ liked sweets and honey. After performing the ‘Asr prayer, he used to visit his wives, going close to them. So he went to Hafsah, daughter of ‘Umar, and stayed with her more than his usual stay. I (‘A’ishah) became jealous and asked about that. It was said to me, ‘A woman of her family sent her a small vessel of honey as a gift, and she gave a drink to Allah’s Messenger made from it.’ I said, “By Allah, we will contrive a plot against him.’ I said to Sawdah bint Zam’ah, When the Messenger visits you and draws close *’ Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :572 ’ Fath Al-Bdri 9:287. ’3| It appears in a narration that follows. ’ Muslim 2 :1100.

to you, say to him, Have you eaten Maghdjv?’ And when he says to you, “No’, then ask him, What is this odor?’ He will say to you, ‘Hafsah has given me a drink of honey.’ Then you should say to him, The honeybees might have eaten from Urfut, and I will also say the same to him. Safiyyah, you should also say this.’ Sawdah later said, It was under compulsion that I had decided to state that which you told me; soon, by Allah, he was standing at my door.’ So when Allah’s Messenger jgj came near her, she said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Did you eat Maghdjv?’ He said, 140.’ She again said, Then what is this odor?’ He said, * *) • « mi** • V * * • * ,*# q * Lp 4jjmM ignJL*** iHafsah gave me honey to drink.* She said, The honeybees might have eaten from ‘Urfut.’** ‘A’ishah continued, “When he came to me I said the same to him. He then visited Safiyyah and she also said similar to him. When he again visited Hafsah, she said, ‘O Messenger of Allah, should I not give you that (drink)?’ He said, «J do not need it.* Sawdah said, *By Allah! We have prevented him from drinking honey.’ I said to her, ‘Keep quiet!’ ”* 1 ’ Muslim also recorded thisHadUh, ’ butthiswording is from Al-Bukhari. In the narration of Muslim, ‘A’ishah said, “The Messenger of Allah used to hate to have a bad odor coming from him”¹³¹ This is why they suggested to him that he ate Maghdfir, because it causes a bad odor. When he said, «No, I had some honey.* They said that the bees ate from a tree that is called Al-Vifut, which has Maghdfirgum, suggesting that this is the reason behind the bad odor they claimedwas coming from him. The latter narration, collected through Tlrwah from ‘A’ishah, mentions that itwas Hafsahwhogave theProphet^ the honey. 111 Fath Al-B&ri 9 :287 121 Muslim 2:1101,1102. 131 Muslim 2:1102.

In another narration collected from TJbayd bin ‘Umayr, from ‘A’ishah, it was Zaynab bint Jahsh who gave the honey to the Prophet si, while ‘A’ishah and Hafsah were the plotters. Allah knows best. Some might say that they were two separate incidents. However, it is not likely that the Ayat were revealed about both incidents, if indeed they were two separate incidents. Allah knows best. A Ijadhith that Imam Ahmad collected in the Musnad mentions that ‘A’ishah and Hafsah were the plotters. Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “I was eager to ask ‘Umar about the two ladies among the wives of the Prophet jg, about whom Allah said, C.«*> jjj 4>l 4!fyou two turn in repentance to Allah your hearts are indeed so inclined;} Then I performed Hajj along with ‘Umar, and on our way back from Hajj he went aside (to relieve himself). I also went aside along with him carrying a tumbler of water. When he finished and returned, I poured water on his hands from the tumbler and he performed ablution. I said, ‘O Commander of the faithful! Who were the two ladies among the wives of the Prophet to whom Allah said, ilfyou two turn in repentance to Allah your hearts are indeed so inclined}?’ TJmar said, *1 am astonished at your question, O Ibn ‘AbbSs.’ ” - Az-Zuhri (a subnarrator) said that “Umar did not like

the question, but he still answered it, saying that they were ‘A’ishah and Hafsa. “Then *Umar went on relating the story and said, We, the people of Quraysh, used to have authority over our women. But when we came to live with the Ansar, we noticed that the Ansari women had the upper hand over their men, so our women started acquiring the habits of the Ansari women. At that time, I was residing at the house of Umayyah bin Zayd, in Al-‘Awali. [x] Once I got angry with my wife, and she talked back to me; I disliked her answering me back. She said. Why A place on the north-eastern outskirts of Al-Madlnah.

do you dislike me talking back to you? By Allah, the wives of the Prophet sg talk back to him, and some of them may not speak with him for the whole day, until nightfall.’ Then I went to Hafsa and asked her, T)o you talk back to Allah’s Messenger?’ She said, ‘Yes.’ I asked, “Does any of you keep Allah’s Messenger angry all day long, until night?’ She replied, ‘Yes.’ I said, “Whoever among you does this is a ruined, losing person! Doesn’t she fear that Allah may get angry for the singer of His Messenger and, thus, she will be ruined? Don’t ask Allah’s Messenger too many things, and don’t retort him in any case. Demand from me whatever you like, and don’t be tempted to imitate your neighbor, for she is more beautiful than you, and more beloved to Allah’s Messenger than you.’ He meant ‘A’ishah. I, and an Ansari neighbor of mine used to visit the Prophet jg in turns. He used to go one day, and I another day. When I went I would bring him the news of what had happened that day regarding the revelation and when he went, he used to do the same for me. In those days it was rumored that the Ghassan (tribe) were preparing their horses to invade us. My companion went and returned to us at night and knocked at my door. I came out to him. He said that a grave thing happened. I asked him, “What is it? Have Ghassan come?’ He replied that it was worse and more serious than that, adding that Allah’s Messenger jg had divorced all his wives. I said, ‘Hafsa is a ruined loser! I expected that would happen some day.’ So I dressed myself and I performed the Subh. prayer. I went to Hafsa and found her weeping. I asked her, ‘Has Allah’s Messenger divorced all of you?’ She replied, 1 don’t know. He is there alone in the upper room.’ I went to the upper room and asked a black slave of the Prophet jg to ask for his permission to see me, and the boy went in and then came out saying, 5 mentioned you to him and he remained silent.’ I then went out and came to the Minbar and found a group of people around it and some of them were weeping. I sat with them for some time, but could not endure the situation. So, I requested to the boy, ‘Will you get the permission for “Umar?’ He went in and then came out saying, 1 mentioned you to him, but he did not reply.’ So, I went to

Minbar and sat with the people who were sitting by the Minbar, but I could not bear the situation, so I went to the boy again and said, “Will you get the permission for ‘Umar?’ He went in and brought the same reply as before. When I was leaving, behold, he called me saying, ‘Allah’s Messenger has granted you permission.’ So, I entered the Prophet’s room, greeted him with the Saldm and saw him lying on a mat without bedding on it, and the mat had left its mark on the body of the Prophet jg. I said, “Have you divorced your wives, O Allah’s Messenger?’ He raised his eyes to me and replied no. I said, 'Allahu Akbar. O Allah’s Messenger! We, the people of Quraysh used to have the upper hand over our women. But when we came to Al- Madxnah, we found a people whose women had the upper hand over them. Our women started learning this behavior from them. Once, I got angiy with my wife, and she talked back to me. I disliked that behavior from her and she said, Why do you dislike that I talk back to you? By Allah, the Prophet’s wives talk back to him and one of them would ignore him the whole day, until

the night.' I said to her, Whoever does this among them is the ruined loser! Does she feel safe from Allah getting angry with her on account of His Messenger's anger? In that case, she would be ruined.' On that the Prophet jg smiled. I then said, 'O Allah's Messenger! I went to Hafsa and said to her, 'Do not be tempted to imitate your companion ('A'ishah) for she is more beautiful than you and more beloved to the Prophet.' The Prophet sgs smiled again. When I saw him smiling, I said, 'Does the Messenger feel calm?' He said, 'Yes.' So, I sat down and cast a glance at the room, and by Allah, I couldn't see anything of importance, except three hides. I said, 'Invoke Allah, O Allah's Messenger, to make your followers prosperous, for the Persians and the Byzantines have been made prosperous and given worldly luxuries, even though they do not worship Allah.' The Prophet jig sat upright and said. SlliJl^ ^ iklji !i_>lkijl jjl U dji kiLijU «0 Ibn Al-Khattab! Do you have any doubt? These people have been given rewards of their good deeds in this world only. I asked the Prophet jig, "Please beg Allah's forgiveness for me,

O Allah's Messenger.' The Prophet swore that he would not go to his wives for one month, because of his severe anger towards them, until Allah the Exalted and Most Honored censured him." 11 Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal also collected this Hadith using various chains of narration.12 * Al-Bukhari and Muslim also collected it from Ibn 'Abbas, who said, "For a whole year, I was eager to ask TJmar bin Al-Khattab about an Ayah. However, I hesitated out of respect for him. Once, he went on a Hajj trip and I accompanied him. On our way back, he stopped to relieve himself behind some trees of Arak. I stopped until he finished and then walked along with him and asked him, 'O Leader of the believers! Who are the two women who helped each other (or plotted) against the Prophet 2|5?' "3 * This is the narration that Al-Bukhari collected, while Muslim recorded that Ibn 'Abbas asked, "Who are the two women about whom Allah the Exalted said, ibut if you help one another against him,}" TJmar replied, "A'ishah and Hafsa."4 * Muslim mentioned the rest of the Hadith. Muslim also recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said that TJmar bin Al-Khattab said to him, "When Allah's Messenger ig stayed away from his wives, I entered the Masjid and found people striking the ground with pebbles. They said, 'Allah's Messenger has divorced his wives.' That occurred before Hijab was commanded. I said to myself, T must investigate this news today.' " So he mentioned the Hadith in which he went to 'A'ishah and Hafsa and admonished them. He then said, T went in and found Rabah, the servant of Allah's Messenger sitting on a window sill. I called, 'O Rabah, seek permission for me from Allah's Messenger.' " He then mentioned the story as we mentioned above. TJmar continued, "I said, 'O Messenger of Allah, what trouble do you 11 Ahmad 1:33,34. Fath Al-Bari 9:187, 5:137, Muslim 2:111, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :224 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :366 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 : 525. 141 Muslim 2:1 108.

feel from your wives? If you have divorced them, verily Allah is with you, His angels, Jibril, Mikal, I, Abu Bakr and the rest of believers are with you.' Often, when I talked, all praise is due to Allah, I hoped that Allah would testify to the words that I uttered. And so the Ayat of option 11 * was revealed. Allah said, i\$£ £\$ J 4 JSj iMaybe his Lord, if he divorces you, will give him in your place wives better than you,} and, k Ari . li, S* Sil c>jf »/ 1/ow help one another against him, then verily, Allah is his Protector, and Jibril, and the righteous among the believers; and after that the angels are his helpers.} I said, 'Messenger of Allah, have you divorced them?' He said, *No.' I stood at the door of the Masjid and called out at the top of my voice, The Messenger of Allah has not divorced his wives.' It was on this

occasion that this Ayah was revealed, <%. iS Zp s iWhen any matter pertaining to peace or alarm comes to them, they broadcast it; whereas, if they would refer it to the Messenger and those who have been entrusted with authority among them, those of them who are engaged in obtaining intelligence would indeed know (what to do with) it>(4:83) It was I who understood (and properly investigated) this matter.”¹²¹ Similar was said by Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak and others. 131 The Ayah, ikPf c^,} iand the righteous among the believers;} refers to Abu Bakr and Umar. Al-Hasan Al-Basri added AllowingtheProphetjg tochoosebetweendivorcinghiswivesornot ¹²¹ Muslim 2 :1 105. At-Tabari 23:486.

‘Uthman to them. Layth bin Abi Sulaym said from Mujahid: Steffi iand the righteous among the believers;} includes ‘Ali bin Abi Talib also. Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas said, “ Umar said, The wives of the Prophet^ were all jealous for his affection, and I said to them, J& 4 Aj^} iMaybe his Lord, if he divorces you, will give him instead of you, wives better than you.} Thereafter, this Ayah was revealed.’ ”* 1 ' We mentioned before that ‘Umar said statements that were confirmed by the Qur’an, such as about the revelation about Hijab [see 33:53] and the captive idolaters sifter the battle of Badr [see 8:67]. ‘Umar’s suggestion to take the Station of Ibrahim as a place for prayer and Allah revealed this Ayah; }And take you the Maqam (station) of Ibrahim as a place of prayer.} (2:125) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Anas said that Umar bin Al- Khattab said, “I heard news that the Mothers of the faithful had a dispute with the Prophet jg. So I advised them, saying, ‘Either stop bothering Allah’s Messenger or Allah might provide him better wives than you.’ When I was talking to the last one among the Mothers of the faithful, she said, ‘O ‘Umar! Is it that the Messenger of Allah cannot advise his wives, so that you interfere between him and them?’ I stopped upon hearing this from her, but Allah revealed; y’Jjc yl—l C~» J ill) A) ^-c-} <em iMaybe his Lord, if he divorces you, will give him instead of you, • wives better than you, submitting, believers, obedient, worshipping, Sa’iltat, previously married and virgins.y*2 111 FathAl-Bari 8:528. At-Jabari 23:488.

^ tm X/-' ' \Kf * xA " » 'V*' -*" *>> -?*" \—jjoyyi ip-r-*i'iJ(T-r.^d 1v_i^v<>-r5 The wife mentioned here was Umm Salamah, and she is the one who advised “Umar to stop interfering between the Prophet jg and his wives, as is confirmed in Sahih Al-BukhariJ Allah’s statement, 'r~t y^y yA-’r Cjyy02<y*rj '*3 ^ eJo’.1*~oc-J Is Q cjiuy isubmitting, believers, obedient, turning repentance, worshipping)> is clear in its implications, while, iSa’ihat^ means, fasting, according to Abu Hurayrah, ‘A’ishah, Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ikrimah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ata’, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Abu Malik, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-Rabl* bin Anas, As-Suddi, and others. 121 -1*1% Ujj») iy lyil. pit&2 v cjs0c u 6j5s; ptf t sf^ v J ^^ \$ Ji !Er.^ \$£\$0^^ u d> ® v& ^Vf 32 S0J C>jj> U p-Jl OjJy* j>-i £jj* /i" udjl) 4 jcA u 111 FathAl-Bari 8:16. 121 At-Tabari 23 :490 , Al-Qurtubi 18 : 93 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :224

46. O you who believe! Protect yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell) whose fuel is men and stones, over which are (appointed) angels stem (and) severe, who disobey not the commands they receive from Allah, but do that which they are commanded.^ 47. (It will be said in the Hereafter) O you who disbelieve! Make no excuses this Day! You are being requited only for what you used to do.} 48. O you who believe! Turn to Allah with sincere repentance! It may be that your Lord will expiatefrom you your sins, and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow - the Day that Allah will not

disgrace the Prophet and those who believe with him . Their light will run forward before them and in their right hands. They will say: “Our Lord! Keep perfect our light for us and grant us forgiveness. Verily, You are Able to do all things.”} Teaching One’s Family the Religion and Good Behavior ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas; 4&£\$ £3 4Protect yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell)} He said, “Work in the obedience of Allah, avoid disobedience of Allah and order your families to remember Allah, then Allah will save you from the Fire.” * Mujahid also commented on: 4Protect yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell)} saying, “Have Taqwa of Allah and order your family to have Taqwa of Him.”*21 Qatadah said, “He commands obedience to Allah, to not disobey Allah, he orders his family to obey His orders and helps them to act upon His orders. When one sees disobedience, he stops them and forbids them from doing it.” * Similar was said by Ad-Dahhak and Muqatil; “It is an *l * At-Tabari 23 :491 ' At-Tabari 23:492. * At-Tabari 23:492.

obligation for the Muslim to teach his near family members, and his male and female slaves what Allah has made obligatory for them and what Allah has forbidden for them.” There is a Hadith that confirms the meaning of this Ayah. Ahmad, Abu Dfiwud and At-Tirmidhi recorded that Ar-Rabl‘ bin Sabrah said that his father said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, •Ifcki “Order the children to pray when they reach the age of seven and when they reach the age of ten, discipline them for (not performing) it.“ This is the narration that Abu Dawud collected; At-Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Hasan. ”*2 Fuel for Hell and a Description of its Angels Allah said, iwhose fuel is men and stones,} indicating that the Children of Adam will be fuel for the Fire that will feed it, iand stones} in reference to the idols that were worshipped, just as Allah said in another Ayah, JL --V <. V V-**- S-UJ CZ U, 4Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel for Hell!} (21:98) ‘Abdullah bin MasMd, Mujahid, Abu JaTar Al-Baqir and As- Suddi said that these are sulfur stones that are more putrid than rotten corpses, according to Mujahid.*3 ’ Allah’s statement, 1% <\$>} (1 * Al-Qurfubi 18:196. * Ahmad 3 :404 , Abu Dawud 1 :332 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 2 :445 * Af-Tabari 1 :381

70 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr iover which are (appointed) angels stem (and) severe,) means, their nature of behavior is stem, because the mercy has been taken out of their hearts for those who disbelieve in Allah, 4"\"j±) ^severe) meaning, their structure is powerful, strong and frightening, • V iwho disobey not the commands they receive from Allah, but do that which they are commanded.) meaning, whatever Allah commands them, they rush to obey Him, without delay for even a twinkling of an eye. They are able to fulfill the command; they are called Az-Zabaniyah, meaning, the keepers and guards of Hell, may Allah give us shelter from them. No Excuse will be accepted from the Disbeliever on the Day of Resurrection Allah said. f K 'S&q J31 v i & 1\$ 0i) 40 you who disbelieve! Make no excuses this Day! You are being requited only for what you used to do.) meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, the disbeliever will be told, “Do not offer any excuse this Day, because it will not be accepted from you; you will only be recompensed for what you used to do. Today, you will receive the punishment for your actions.” Encouraging sincere Repentance Allah the Exalted said, 4Cf£ & Ji& !£«: \$£> 40 you who believe! Turn to Allah with sincere repentance!) meaning, a true, firm repentance that erases the evil sins that preceded it and mend the shortcoming of the repenting person, encouraging and directing him to quit the evil that he

71 Surah 66. At-Tahm (6-8) (Part-28) used to do. Allah said, may be that your Lord will expiate from you your sins, and admit you into Gardens under which rivers flow} And when Allah says, "it may be," it means He shall. ilz p: ithe Day that Allah will not disgrace the Prophet and those who believe with him meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, Allah will not disgrace those who believed in the Prophet jg, nJ &> iTheir light ivill run forward before them and in their right hands. as we explained in Surat Al-Hadldf^ iThey will say: "Our Lord! Keep perfect our light for us and grant us forgiveness. Verily, You are Able to do all things."} Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and Al-Hasan Al-Basri and other said, "This is the statement that the believers will say on the Day of Resurrection, when they witness the light of the hypocrites being extinguished."121 Imam Ahmad recorded that a man from the tribe of Banu Kinanah said, "I prayed behind the Messenger of Allah during the year of the Conquest (of Makkah), and heard him say, •iiQJI fj j ^ (•-P" «0 Allah! Please, do not disgrace me on the Day of Resurrection .n"131 111 See volume nine, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hadld (57 :12). At-Tabari 23:496. 131 Ahmad 4:234.

o-^> (vr^* •!>\$> OjiiiiJb Qti4 ^3^6 <i>i <^a-c i2i£= J»j) oV^'5 ^ -d^iy 42 lit 4 £ jUtf j_jj liS <uf o; C^6, Ji Ci£;Ui o^4^> 49. O Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be severe against them; their abode will be Hell, and worst indeed is that destination .} 420. Allah sets forth an example for those who disbelieve: the wife of Nuh and the wife of Lut. They were under two of our righteous servants, but they both betrayed them. So, they availed them not against Allah and it was said: "Enter the Fire along with those who enter!"} The Command for Jihad against the Disbelievers and the Hypocrites Allah the Exalted orders His Messenger to perform Jihad against the disbelievers and hypocrites, the former with weapons and armaments and the later by establishing Allah's legislated penal code, iand be severe against them} meaning, in this life. itheir abode will be Hell, and worst indeed is that destination.} that is, in the Hereafter. The Disbeliever shall never benefit from His Believing Relative on the Day of Resurrection Allah the exalted said, iAllah sets forth an example for those who disbelieve} meaning, the disbelievers who live together in this life with Muslims, their mixing and mingling with Muslims will not help the disbelievers, nor will it avail them with Allah, until and unless they gain faith in their hearts. Then Allah mentioned the parable, saying,

zof/e of Nih and the wife of Lilt. They were under two of our righteous servants means, they were the wives of two of Allah's Messengers and were their companions by day and night, eating with them and sleeping with them, as much as any marriage contains of interaction between spouses. However, it they both betrayed them meaning, in the faith, they did not adhere to the faith sent through their husbands nor accepted their message. Therefore, all the intimate knowledge of their husbands neither helped them nor prevented punishment, hence Allah's statement, 4U\ CJift CSu 4So, they availed them not against Allah means, because their wives were disbelievers, ^and it was said meaning, to these wives, iSib'M£ 3&\ iEnter the Fire along with those who enteric The part of the Ayah that reads, ibut they both betrayed them^ does not pertain to committing illegal sexual intercourse, but to refusing to accept the religion. Surely, the wives of the Prophets were immune from committing illegal sexual intercourse on account of the honor that Allah has granted His Prophets, as we explained in Surat An-Nur. 11 ^ Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "They betrayed them by not following their religion. The wife of Prophet Nuh used to expose his secrets, informing his oppressive people whenever any person embraced the faith with Nuh. As for the wife of Lut This was briefly mentioned in volume seven , in the Tafstr of Surat An-Nur (24:26).

75 Surah 66. At-Tahnm (11-12) <Part-28) people of the earth and the most disbelieving. By Allah! His wife was not affected by her husband's disbelief, because she obeyed her Lord. Therefore, let it be known that Allah is the Just Judge Who will not punish anyone except for their own sins." Ibn Jarir recorded that Sulayman said, "The wife of Fir'awn was tortured under the sun and when Fir'awn would finish the torture session, the angels would shade her with their wings. She was shown her house in Paradise."² Ibn Jarir said that Al-Qasim bin Abi Bazzah said, "Fir'awn's wife used to ask. Who prevailed?' When she was told, "Musa and Harun prevailed", she said, "I believe in the Lord of Musa and Harun." Fir'awn sent his aides to her and said to them, "Find the biggest stone. If she insists on keeping her faith, throw the stone on her, otherwise she is my wife. When they came to her, she looked up to the sky and was able to see her house in Paradise. She persisted on the faith and her soul was then captured. The stone was thrown on her lifeless body."³ This is the meaning of her statement, "My Lord! Build for me a home with You in Paradise, and save me from Fir'awn and his work," means, "deliver me from him, because I am innocent of his actions," and save me from the people who are wrongdoers." Her name was Asiyah bint Muzahim, may Allah be pleased with her. Allah said, "Inna Inna Maryam, the daughter of 'Imran who guarded her chastity (private part)." 111 At-Tabari 23:500. [2] At-Tabari 23:500. At-Tabari 23:500. See the section about reports such as this and the previous in the beginning of this book

aMany men have reached the level of perfection, but none among women have reached this level except Asiyah - Fir'awn's wife, Maryam-the daughter of 'Imran, and Khadijah-the daughter of Khuwaylid. And no doubt, the superiority of 'A'ishah to other women is like the superiority of Tharfd to other meals. b11 In my book, Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah, [21 I have mentioned these Hadiths using their various chains of narration in relating the stoxy of Prophet Isa and his mother Maryam, peace be upon them, all praise be to Allah.

Surah 67: Al-Mulk

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Opening

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Opening op" ip is& }£ \$ & Pj ;p. yS^ £• 32- 4f ®:JA® 4® j*j '®& jkj lip- ptii lik)^ <-Pi Pi' gj' f i.p-?P l>j iSy cl* g3^ y>" <pj» j£i CxtVJ jJoiU Ky»y CpPj pPi £jtf jLPI £> -Pi @-Ap 41. Blessed be He in Whose Hand is the dominion; and He is Able to do all things.} 42 . Who has created death and life that He may test you which of you is best in deed. And He is the Almighty, the Oft- Forgiving; 43. Who has created the seven heavens one above the other; you can see no fault in the creation of the Most Gracious. Then look again. Can you see any rifts?} 44. Then look again and yet again, your sight will return to you Khdsi', and worn out.} 45. And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps, and We have made such lamps (as) missiles to drive away the Shaydtin, and have prepared for them the torment of the blazing Fire.} Glorification of Allah and mentioning the Creation of Death, Life, the Heavens and the Stars Allah the Exalted glorifies His Noble Self and informs that the dominion is in His Hand. This means that He deals with all of His creatures however He wishes and there is none who can reverse His decree. He is not questioned concerning what He does because of His force. His wisdom and His justice. For this reason Allah says, i\$4&\$& 4and He is Able to do all things.} Then Allah says, oplP

to each other, meaning that they are in elevated ascension, some of them being stacked above others, or separated with space between them? There are two views concerning this, and the most correct opinion seems to be the latter as is proven in the Hadlth of Isra' (the Prophet's Night Journey) and other narrations. Concerning Allah's statement, i?*** oi cpy iyou can see nofault in the creation of the Most Gracious.} means, it (the creation) is done in a flawless manner, and these are connected with each other so as to forms a straight level, having no disunion, conflict, inconsistency, deficiency, flaw or defect. This is the reason that Allah says, iij J* JvaJl i iThen look again. Can you see any rifts?} meaning, look at the sky and pay close attention to it. Do you see any flaw, deficiency, defect or rifts in it? Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Ath-Thawri and others said concerning Allah's statement, Hi isj j4 j iThen look again. Can you see any rifts?} that it means cracks.¹¹¹ As-Suddi said that. Hi& iCan you see any rifts?} means any tears.¹²¹ Qatadah said, Hi is) iCan you see any rifts?} means, 'do you see any defects O Son of Adam (mankind)?' In reference to Allah's statement, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8:235, Al-Qurtubi 18:209, and At-Tabari 121 Al-Qurtubi 18:209.

iThen look again and yet again,} Qatadah said, "It means (look) twice." S[2xH_] iyour sight will return to you Khasi ',} Ibn 'Abbas said that Khasi' means humiliated.* 11 Mujahid and Qatadah both said that it means despised . iand worn out.} Ibn 'Abbas said that this means it will be exhausted.*³¹ Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi all said that it means broken down fatigue that comes from weakness.

Thus, the Ayah means that if you continuously looked, no matter how much you look, your sight will return to you. iiLAi.} iKhdsi'} due to the inability to see any flaw or defect (in Allah's creation). iand worn out.} meaning, exhausted and broken down feebleness due to the great amount of repeated looking without being able to detect any deficiency. Then, after Allah negated any deficiency in the creation of the heavens, He explains their perfection and beauty. He says, }And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps,} This refers to the stars which have been placed in the heavens, some moving and some stationary. 111 At-Tabari 23:507. *21 At-Tabari 23:507. *3) Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :235

iand We have made them (as) missiles to drive away the Shaydtin,) The pronoun 'them' in His statement, "and We have made them" is the same type of statement as the stars being referred to as lamps. This does not mean that they are actually missiles, because the stars in the sky are not thrown. Rather, it is the meteors beneath them that are thrown and they are taken from the stars. And Allah knows best. Concerning Allah's statement, ij^S\ iand We have prepared for them the torment of the blazing Fire.) means, We have made this disgrace for the devils in this life and We have prepared for them the torment of the blazing Fire in the Hereafter.' This is as Allah said in the beginning of Surat As-Saffat, J! Oydli V jf && iliii dili- j* v'j* j£> tfvyjt df if, iijjfa 4Verily, We have adorned the near heaven with the stars (for beauty). And to guard against every rebellious devil. They cannot listen to the higher group (angels) for they are pelted from every side. Outcast, and theirs is a constant (or painful) torment. Except such as snatch away something by stealing, and they are pursued by a flaming fire of piercing brightness.) [37 :6-7] Qatadah said, "These stars were only created for three purposes: Allah created them as adornment for the heaven (sky), as missiles for the devils and as signs for navigation. Therefore, whoever seeks to interpret any other meanings for them other than these, then verily he has spoken with his own opinion, he has lost his portion and burdened himself with that which he has no knowledge of." Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi

iHH assessi\$! Hatim both recorded 1 this statement. 111 v>.. ,, ,, ju-> jfc s *A'.ift'if'i'frz*"£>S! ? A"\'-s\ V&^ " !A? fe iy 'H Cpi?*^ ,, JUJ jSo J>* U-^S, U ^ j* <A y& ># Ji 0jMczCsj w\$£ £\$j08 -i££ iL^Jil^jJi!_j ^ ©jft jii> J^ iiii ol, J^i £ Jii jj |2" jj ijlig k ^ X >- ^ ' ^ (Cj^l !Aa^ Vjiia'I (p^iotj I ^6. And Jfor f/iouse who disb ?z e in fz h°n*,> ,, ,%, , , is the torment of Hell, and worst indeed is that K,\ * *sJ \K ~ "S .f destination .V <7. Hte (fey« crcf therein, they will hear =^ its Shahiq while it is simmering. 48. It almost bursts up with fury. Every time a group is cast therein, its keepers will ask: "Did no wamer come to you?"} 49. They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer did come to us, but we rejected him and said: 'Allah never sent down anything; you are only in great error.' " } 410. And they will say: "Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!"} 411. Then they will confess their sin. So, away with the dwellers of the blazing Fire!} At-Tabari 23:508.

The Description of Hell and Those Who will enter into it Allah the Exalted says, ^and} meaning, 'and We have prepared,' ifor those who disbelieve in their Lord is the torment of Hell, and worst indeed is that destination This means that this will be the worst end and a terrible destiny. ^U.p . U Ijjj* Ijifl \$When they are cast therein, they will hear its Shahlq} Ibn Jarir said, "This means the sound of shouting." I1 ' ij£ Job iwhile it is simmering.} Ath-Thawri said, "It will boil them just as a small number of seeds are boiled in a lot of water." Then Allah says, f u ilt almost bursts up with Jury.} meaning, some parts of it

almost break apart from other parts due to the severity of its rage and anger with them. 4^ 4 .J. J. 'if iEvery time a group is cast therein, its keepers will ask: "Did no wamer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer did come to us, but we rejected him and said : 'Allah never sent down anything; you are only in great error.' " } In these Ayat Allah reminds of His justice in dealing with His creatures and that He does not punish anyone until the proof has been established against them and a Messenger has been sent to them. This is similar to Allah's statement. m At-Jabari 23:508

86 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr '—'v Cs*~ <15 fro 4And We newer punish until We Jurwe sent a Messenger. [17:15] Allah also says, f& sjs fj jb j» tjgs. fjj dli ^ ijSli 'j£ i4 4^7/ iwlien they reach it, the gates thereof will be opened. And its keepers will say, "Did not the Messengers come to youfrom yourselves, reciting to you the Aydt ofyour Lord, and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "Yes," but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!" } [39:71] Thus, they have no recourse but to blame themselves and they will feel remorseful when such remorse will be of no benefit to them. They will say, 4j^s\ ^ gr c& jf ££ 2* J)> 4Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!} meaning, *if we would have benefited from our intellects or listened to the truth that Allah revealed, we would not have been disbelieving in Allah and misguided about Him. But we did not have understanding to comprehend what the Messengers came with, and we did not have the intelligence to guide us to following them.' Allah then says, rt iThen they will confess their sin. So, away with the dwellers of the blazing Fire!} Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Al-Bakhtari At-Tal that he heard from one of the Companions that the Messenger of Allah M said, "The people will not be destroyed until they themselves confess

their guilt . (11 1 UrrrTj 1\$) Cj" -4^ (4?J 4^4 Ot| JiJfl {ft 2 4uif&;£££ vt *ti^ 4i; ,v tife crc j ^12. Verily, those who fear their Lord unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.} 413. And whether you keep your talk secret or disclose it, verily, He is the All-Knower ofwlu it is in the breasts.} 414. Should not He Who has created know? And He is the Most Kind and Courteous, All-Aware.} 415. He it is Who has made the earth subservient to you; so walk in the paths thereofand eat ofHis provision . And to Him will be the resurrection . } The Reward ofthoseWho fear their Lord unseen Allah informs of he who fears standing before his Lord, being frightened about matters between himself and Allah when he is not in the presence of other people. So he refrains from disobedience and he performs acts of obedience when no one sees him except Allah. Allah mentions that this person will have forgiveness and a great reward. This means that his sins will be remitted and he will be rewarded abundantly. This is similar to what has been confirmed in the Two Sahflis, \> 'i >J at *There are seven people whom Allah the Exalted will shade in the shade ofHis Throne on the Day when there will be no shade except its shade. Then he mentioned that among those people are: ji-Lui ijj-iJ JJ *3)1 : Jlii JUi-j oli CfO «2L: u iJiij. jjte i JU uiUti lA man who is tempted by a beautiful woman of high social status, but he says: 'Verily, I fear Allah.' Another person from lit Ahmad 5 .293

88 Tafsir Ibrr Kathir among them is a man who gives charity and he conceals it so that his left hand does not know what his right hand spent. a111 Then He says, while informing that He is aware of the innermost conscience and secrets, }And whether you keep your talk secret or disclose it, verily, He is the All-Knower ofwhat is in the breasts. meaning, that which occurs in the hearts (ideas, thoughts, etc.). 4Should not He Who has created know?} This means, 'doesn't the Creator know?' JLV&i %} iAtid He

is the Most Kind and Courteous, All-Aware (of everything).} Allah's Favor of subjugating the Earth to His Servants Then Allah mentions His favor to His creation in subjugating the earth to them, and making it subservient to them. This is by His making it a stable abode and dwelling place. He placed in it mountains and caused water springs to gush forth from it. He fashioned pathways, and placed useful things in it and places fertile for the growth of fruit and vegetation. Allah says, 4 p 4\ \$} iHe it is Who has made the earth subservient to you; so walk in the paths thereof} meaning, travel wherever you wish throughout its regions and frequent its countrysides and all the areas of its domain in your various journeys to seek earnings and trade. And know that your efforts will not benefit you anything unless Allah makes matters easy for you. Allah continues to say, (i| Path Al-Bdri 2 168 , and Muslim 2:715.

and eat of His provision. Thus, striving by using the means (to attain something) does not negate the necessity of depending upon Allah (At-Tawakkutj This is similar to what Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Umar bin Al-Khattab, that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, uiL CJs-> "If you would trust in Allah as He truly should be trusted in, He would surely provide for you as He provides for the birds. They set out in the morning with empty stomachs and return in the evening with full stomachs. At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah all recorded this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih." > So this confirms that the bird searches morning and evening for its sustenance while depending upon Allah. For He is the Subduer, the Controller and the One Who causes everything. iAnd to Him will be the resurrection .} meaning, the place of return on the Day of Judgement. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddi and Qatadah all said that Manakibiha (its paths) means its outermost borders, its roads and its regions. 13 j j j* {4 f* df, dJ* ol .cUlf j 4 ^4^ a JS Oi iTd xHj of} ld~>£ {isr fil 444 £ jnijiy y£> jj£jf jj Hi il6. Do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven, will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake?} ** Ahmad 1 :52. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:8, An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd, the book of Ar-Raq&'iq, Tuhfat Al-Ashraf 8 :79, and Ibn Majah 2 :1394. * At-Tabari 23 :512, and Al-Qurtubi 18 :215.

90 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 417. Or do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven, will not send against you a Hdsib? Then you shall know how has been My warning.) 418. And indeed those before them rejected, then how terrible was My reproach?) 419. Do they not see the birds above them, spreading out their wings and folding them in? None upholds them except the Most Gracious. Verily, He is the All-Seer of everything.) How can You feel Secure against the Punishment of Allah while He is Able to seize You however He wills? This is another indication of His gentleness and His mercy with His creatures. He is able to punish them because some of them disbelieve in Him and worship others besides Him, yet He .is forbearing, He pardons, and He gives respite for an appointed time without hastening. This is as He says, » dfc u \j&s. il. & U 4 And if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth; but He gives them respite to an appointed term: and when their term comes, then verily, Allah is Ever All-Seer of His servants .) (35:45] Here Allah says, % fti 4 Do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven, will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake?) meaning, that it would move back and forth, and be disrupted. pfc J& 4* ft ft 40r do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven, will not send against you a Hasib?) meaning, a wind containing gravel that will strike you, as Allah says in another Ayah,

'j cx ^ ji a; j <Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up, or that He will not send against you a violent sandstorm? Then, you shall find no trustee.) (17:68] And similarly, here Allah threatens them with His statement, iThen you shall know how has been My warning.) meaning, "how is My admonition and what will happen to those who disregard and reject it.' Then Allah says, i « os!'^ iAnd indeed those before them rejected,) meaning, from the previous nations and the old generations that have passed. Then Allah says, ig\$Jg) ithen how terrible was My reproach?) meaning, Tiow was My rebuke of them and my punishment of them.' Meaning, it was great, severe and painful. The flight of Birds is by the Power of Allah and it is a ProofthatHe sees everything small and large Allah says, ^5 Ji lit 2\$) iDo they not see the birds above them, spreading out their wings and folding them in?) meaning, sometimes they spread their wings out in the wind (gliding) and other times they gather and spread (flapping) the wings in flight 4None upholds them) meaning, in the air.

ieexcept the Most Gracious meaning, Allah holds them up in the air by subject- ing the air to them out of His mercy and His gentleness. iks* fCA ^ iVerily, He is the All- Seer of everything .)> means, with what is beneficial and suitable for all of His crea- tures. This is similar to His statement, /A ytf 4 % y 4Do they not see the birds held in the midst of the sky? None upholds them but Allah. Verily, in this are clear Ayat for people who believe.} (24:79] Ui jl] ii inii oj yt iSM !i» atf £ fe^ ^& jj fe oi&£^ cr 1'£ JS5 a# 25 #*&&&\$ oj, icpi Cii ,£* OjSjij *3^ ^ (1 J j&ti JI ji L VJi »j»-j ciz- iilj *j); Uli ^ui IS LSjj jil is Li] Ji W <Z& 420. Who is it besides the Most Gracious that can be an army to you to help you? The disbelievers are in nothing but

93Surah 67. Al-Mulk (20-27) (Part-29 delusion .} 421 . Who is it that can provide for you ifHe should withhold His provision? Nay, but they continue to be in pride, and flee.} 422 . Is he who walks prone on his face, more rightly guided, or he who walks upright on a straight path?} 423. Say: "It is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing and seeing, and hearts. Little thanks you give."} 424. Say: "It is He Who has created you on the earth, and to Him shall you be gathered."} 425. They say: "When will this promise come to pass, if you are telling the truth?"} 426. Say: "The knowledge is with Allah only, and I am only a plain wamer."} 427. But when they will see it approaching, the faces of those who disbelieve will be sad and grievous, and it will be said: "This is what you were callingfor!"} No One will helpYou and No One can grant Sustenance except for Allah Allah addresses the idolaters who worship others besides Him, seeking help and sustenance from them. Allah rebukes them for what they believe, and He informs them that they will not attain that which they hope for. Allah says, ^ £j' ^4\&\$} 4Who is it besides the Most Gracious that can be an army to you to help?} meaning, there is no protector or helper for you besides Him. This is the reason that Allah says, 4 ^1 4The disbelievers are in nothing but delusion.} Then Allah says, 4% a iii '\$} 4Who is it that can provide for you ifHe should withhold His provision?}

meaning, who is it that can provide for you if Allah cuts off your sustenance? There is no one who gives, withholds, creates, provides and helps other than Allah alone, Who has no partner. This proves that they know this, yet they still worship others besides Him. Thus, Allah says, iNay, but they continue meaning, they persist in their transgression, lying and misguidance. 4to be in pride, and flee. meaning, they continue in obstinance, arrogance and fleeing away from the truth. They do not listen to it nor do they follow it. The Parable ofthe Disbeliever and the Believer hen Allah says, ils he who walks prone

on his face, more rightly guided, or he who walks upright on a straight path?} This is a parable which Allah made of the believer and the disbeliever. So the condition of the disbeliever is like one who walks prone on his face. This is like a person walking bent over on his face (with his head down) instead of walking upright. This person does not know where he is going or how. Rather, he is lost, astray and confused. Is this person more guided, it is for he who walks upright meaning, he who stands erect. >>? ion a straight path?} meaning, this person who walks upright is on a clear path, and he is straight within himself while his path is straight as well. This is their likeness in this world, and their likeness will be the same in the Hereafter. So the believer will be gathered (on the Day of Judgement) walking upright upon the straight path and the vast and spacious Paradise will be opened up for him. However, the disbeliever will be gathered

95 Surah 67. Al-Mulk (20-27) (Part-29) walking down on his face to the Hellfire. 4 % d) \$ ojj Ji ly!" ly !»& ^Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions and what they used to worship instead of Allah, and lead them on to the way of flaming Fire.} (37:22,23) "Companions" here means those like them. Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas bin Malik that it was said, "O Messenger of Allah! How will the people be gathered on their faces?" So the Prophet replied, «/s not He who made them to walk on their legs able to make them walk on their faces?" !! This Hadith is also recorded in the Two Sahih. 121 Allah's Power to create and It being an Evidence of the Final Abode Allah says, x\$ ji i Say it is He Who has created you,} meaning, He initiated your creation after you were not even a thing worth mentioning (i.e., nothing). Then He says, 4^% p&} i and endowed you with hearing and seeing, and hearts.} meaning, intellects and powers of reasoning. i'jfp* U yJf} i Little thanks you give.} meaning, how little you use these abilities that Allah has blessed you with to obey Him, to act according to His commandments, and avoid His prohibitions. 4 Say : "It is He Who has created you on the earth..."} meaning, He has spread and distributed you all throughout the (li Ahmad 3:167. Fath Al-Bari 6 :350 , and Muslim 4:2161.

97 Surah 67. Al-Mulk (28-30) (Part-29) able to reckon or fully comprehend to come to them. fk \Xj} U ol!! ^ 4><j>vr-} 4«>d f/iere wi// become apparent to them from Allah what they had not been reckoning. And the evils of that which they earned will become apparent to them, and that which they used to mock at will encircle them .} (39:47,48) This is why it will be said to them in order to scold and reprimand them, 4Sy0c is ift is*} i This is what you were calling for!} meaning, that you were seeking to hasten. asniK: • ' ' > ant £38iSK21 ^Tl >>> > > / ^ ^ £ T> ^ /<y*f *-4 i- ST \$ 09^1^~VdMolj o||^|0 ov^j la0^*0^ 3*4ll,'a J* < jS ^-'j* o; syf. o** tliy jl o*j ^>' o) J—.lji j»^ /jC jv-ol o) j» yii j j4 ^ Ojiii>i-» u^5 .4, till o>^> ji 4^A ^ £> 428. Sal/: "Tell me! If Allah destroys me, and those with me, or He bestows His mercy on us - who can save the disbelievers from a painful torment?"} 429. Say: "He is the Most Gracious, in Him we believe, and upon Him we rely. So, you will come to know who it is that is in manifest error."} 430. Say: "Tell me! If (all) your water were to sink away, who

98 Tafslr Ibn Kathir then can supply you with flowing water?"} The Death of the Believer will not save the Disbeliever, so let Him reflect upon His Deliverance Allah says, isay} 'O Muhammad to these idolaters who are associating partners with Allah and denying His favors,' hi i jli Giy jl hf* ifl'j ill ^3*1 uj, 'Jhhf'^ i Tell me! If Allah destroys me, and those with me, or He bestows His mercy on us - who can save the disbelievers from a painful torment?} meaning, 'save yourselves, for verily, there is nothing

that can rescue you from Allah except repentance, turning to Him for forgiveness and returning to His religion. Your hopes that torment and exemplary punishment will strike us, will not benefit you. Whether Allah punishes us or has mercy on us, there is no escaping from Allah's punishment and painful torment that you will suffer.' Then Allah says, Sh & ££\$I >\$} iSay: "He is the Most Gracious, in Him we believe, and upon Him we rely.} meaning, *we believe in the Lord of all that exists, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, and upon Him we rely in all of our affairs.' This is as Allah says, 4& jh. % :&&} 4So worship Him and rely upon Him.} (11:123) Thus, Allah continues saying, 4yd yd j \$ £ hfXdh} 4So, you will come to know who it is that is in manifest error.} meaning, 'between Us and you, and to whom the final end (ultimate victory) will be for in this life and in the Hereafter.'

99Surah 67. Al-Mulk (28-30) (Part-29 Reminding ofAllah's Blessingby the springing ofWater and the Threat of It being taken away Demonstrating how merciful He is to His creatures, Allah says; o' iSay: "Tell me! Ifyour water were to sink away meaning, if it were to go away, disappearing into the lowest depths of the earth, then it would not be reachable with iron axes nor strong arms. Gha'ir (sinking) as used here in the Ayah, is the opposite of springing forth. This is why Allah says, iwho then can supply you withflowing water?} meaning, springing forth, flowing, running upon the face of the earth. This means that no one is able to do this except Allah. So, it is merely out of His favor and His grace that He causes water to spring forth for you, and He makes it run to the various regions of the earth in an amount that is suitable for the needs of servants, be it little or abundant. So Allah's is all the praise and thanks.

Surah 68: Al-Qalam

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Opening

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Opening 100 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir The Tafsīrof Surah Nun" (Chapter - 68) Which was revealed in Makkah P- 7« the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Jf* <%» jli* C Cp 0jj£li Jstfj J* ^5 j*^ *4^* o* cfi 41 . Nfm. By thepm and by what they Yastur.> 42. You, by the grace of your Lord, are not insane.) 43. And verily, for you will be reward that is not Mamnun .) 44. And verily, you are on an exalted character.) 45. You will see, and they will see,) 46. Which of you is afflicted with madness.) 47. Verily, your Lord is the best Knower of him who has gone astray from His path, and He is the best Knower of those who are guided.) We have already discussed the special letters of the Arabic alphabet at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. Thus, Allah's saying, 4^> 4Nun), is like Allah's saying. i'j 4Siid), and Allah's saying, *** Also called Surat Al-Qalam.

iQafo, and similar to them from the individual letters that appear at the beginning of Qur'anic chapters. This has been discussed at length previously and there is no need to repeat it here. The Explanation of the Pen Concerning Allah's statement, 4M& 4By the pen The apparent meaning is that this refers to the actual pen that is used to write. This is like Allah's saying, iRead! And your Lord is the Most Generous . Who has taught by the pen. He has taught man that which he knew not.} (96:3-5) Therefore, this statement is Allah's swearing and alerting His creatures to what He has favored them with by teaching them the skill of writing, through which knowledge is attained. Thus, Allah continues by saying. 4and by what they Yastur.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah all said that this means, "what they write." 111 As-Suddi said, "The angels and the deeds of the servants they record." Others said, "Rather, what is meant here is the pen which Allah caused to write the decree when He wrote the decrees of all creation, and this took place fifty-thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth." For this, they present Hadiths that have been reported about the Pen. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Al-Walīd bin Tjbadah bin As-Samit that he said, "My father called for me when he was dying and he said to me: Verily, I heard the Messenger of Allah ;gl say, : Jli 4o 'i jUi3» ifol jU li Jj\ !>)» m At-Tabari 23:527, 528.

8 Verily, the first of what Allah created was the Pen, and He said to it: "Write." The Pen said: "O my Lord, what shall I write?" He said: "Write the decree and whatever will throughout eternity." n'^ This Hadith has been recorded by Imam Ahmad through various routes of transmission. 121 At-Tirmidhi also recorded it from a Hadith of Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi and he (At-Tirmidhi) said about it, "Hasan Sahih, Gharib," 131 Swearing by the Pen refers to the Greatness of the Prophet^ Allah says, iYou, by the grace of your Lord, are not insane.} meaning - and all praise is due to Allah - "you are not crazy as the ignorant among your people claim. They are those who deny the guidance and the clear truth that you have come with. Therefore, they attribute madness to you because of it.' &10 iAnd verily, for you will

be reward that is not Mamnun.} meaning, For you is the great reward, and abundant blessings which will never be cut off or perish, because you conveyed the Message of your Lord to creation, and you were patient with their abuse.’ The meaning of: inot Mamnun is that it will not be cut off. This is similar to Allah’s statement, ‘j*. :ILZ} ia gift without an end.} (1 1:108) and His statement. At-Jabari 23:526. Ahmad 5:317. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :232

iThen they shall have a reward without end> (95:6) Mujahid said, 4Without Mamniin) means “Without reckoning.”¹¹¹ And this refers back to what we have said before.

The Explanation of the Statement: “Verily, You are on

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6049–6077]

an Exalted Character.” Concerning Allah’s statement, iAnd verily, you are on an exalted (standard of) character.\$> Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “Verily, you are oh a great religion, and it is Islam.”¹²¹ Likewise said Mujahid, Abu Malik, As-Suddi and Ar-Rabl’ bin Anas.¹³¹ Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Zayd also said this.¹⁴¹ Sa’id bin Abi ‘Arubah reported from Qatadah that he said concerning Allah’s statement, 4And verily, you are on an exalted (standard of) character. “It has been mentioned to us that Sa’d bin Hisham asked ‘A’ishah about the character of the Messenger of Allah so she replied: ‘Have you not read the Qur’an?’ Sa’d said: ‘Of course.’ Then she said: Verily, the character of the Messenger of Allah ag was the Qur’an.’ ”,sl ‘Abdur-Razzaq recorded similar to this¹⁶¹ and Imam Muslim recorded it in his Sahlh on the authority of Qatadah in its full length.¹⁷¹ This means that he would act according to the commands and the prohibition in the Qur’an. His nature and character were patterned according to the Qur’an, and he abandoned his ¹¹¹ At-Tabari 23:528. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 23 :529 ¹³¹ At-Tabari 23 :529 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur⁸ :243 ¹⁴¹ At-Tabari 23:530. ¹⁵¹ At-Tabari 23:529. ¹⁶¹ ‘Abdur-Razzaq 3 :307 ¹⁷¹ Muslim 1 :513.

¹⁰⁴ Tafsir Ibt Kathtr natural disposition (i.e., the carnal nature). So whatever the Qur’an commanded, he did it, and whatever it forbade, he avoided it. Along with this, Allah gave him the exalted character, which included the qualities of modesty, kindness, bravery, pardoning, gentleness and every other good characteristic. This is like that which has been confirmed in the Two Sahlhs that Anas said, “I served the Messenger of Allah jg for ten years, and he never said a word of displeasure to me (lff), nor did he ever say to me concerning something I had done: “Why did you do that?” And he never said to me concerning something I had not done: *Why didn’t you do this?’ He had the best character, and I never touched any silk or anything else that was softer than the palm of the Messenger of Allah !§• And I never smelled any musk or perfume that had a better fragrance than the sweat of the Messenger of Allah.”¹¹ Imam Al-Bukhari recorded that Al-Bara’ said, “The Messenger of Allah jg had the most handsome face of all the people, and he had the best behavior of all of the people. And he was not tall, nor was he short.”²¹ The Hadiths concerning this matter are numerous. Abu Isa At-Tirmidhi has a complete book on this subject called Kitab Ash-Shamd’il. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘A’ishah said, “The Messenger of Allah ^ never struck a servant of his with his hand, nor did he ever hit a woman. He never hit anything with his hand, except for when he was fighting Jihad in the cause of Allah. And he was never given the option between two things except that the most beloved of the two to him was the easiest of them, as long as it did not involve sin. If it did involve sin, then he stayed farther away from

sin than any of the people. He would not avenge himself concerning anything that was done to him, except if the limits of Allah were transgressed. Then, in that case he would avenge for the sake of Allah.”¹³¹ Imam Ahmad also recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, Fathi Al-Bari 10:471, and Muslim 4 :1814. '2) Fath Al-Bari 6:652 '31 Ahmad 6 :232. Similar with Muslim 7 : 80.

cJaj LkJU »/ have only been sent to perfect righteous behavior . Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith.[^] In reference to Allah’s statement, ^Yom mi// see, and they will see, which of you is afflicted with madness.} then it means, *you will know, O Muhammad - and those who oppose you and reject you, will know - who is insane and misguided among you.’ This is like Allah’s statement. ^Tomorrow they will come to know who is the liar, the insolent one!} (54:26) Allah also says, iAnd verily (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error.} (34:24) Ibn Jurayj reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, it means “You will know and they will know on the Day of Judgement.”^{*21} Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas; iWhich of you is Maftun (afflicted with madness).} means which of you is crazy.¹³¹ This was also said by Mujahid and others as well.’⁴ * The literal meaning of Maftun is one who has been charmed or lured away from the truth and has strayed from it. Thus, the entire statement means, ‘so you will know and they will know,’ or tyou will be informed and they will be informed, as to which of you is afflicted with madness.’ And 111 Ahmad 2:381. * Al-Qurtubi 18 :229 At-Jabari 23 :531. 141 Af-Tabari 23:530.

Allah knows best. Then Allah says, 4Verily, your Lord is the best Knower of him who has gone astray from His path, and He is the best Knower of those who are guided.} meaning, ‘He knows which of the two groups are truly guided among you, and He knows the party that is astray from the truth.’ £2p spLfg% C & i&0^0g 48. So, do not obey the deniers.} 49. They wish that you should compromise with them, so they (too) would compromise with you.} 410. And do not obey every HallafMahin.} ill . A Hammaz, going about with Nattttm,} 412. Hinderer of the good, transgressor, sinful,} 413. ‘Utul, and moreover Zantm .} 414. (He was so) because he had wealth and children.} 415. When Our Ayat are recited to him, he says: "Tales of the men ofold!"} 416. We shall brand him on the snout (nose)!} Prohibition of giving in to the Pressure of the Disbelievers and Their Suggestions, and that They like to meet in the Middle ofthe Path Allah says, ‘just as We have favored you and given you the upright legislation and great (standard of) character,’ 40s>£ i 14;0*\$@g <S> 4So, do not obey the deniers. They wish that you should compromise with them, so they (too) would compromise with you.} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “That you would permit them (their idolatry)

and they also would permit you (to practice your religion).” Mujahid said, 4 ' J*-* jl bu? iThey iws/i i/ oh should compromise with them , so they (too) would compromise with you.) “This means that you should be quiet about their gods and abandon the truth that you are upon.”¹²¹ Then Allah says, ^ v;> 4And do not obey every Hallaf (one who swears much) Mahm (liar or worthless person).} This is because the liar, due to his weakness and his disgracefulness, only seeks protection in his false oaths which hp boldly swears to while using Allah’s Names, and he uses them (false oaths) all the time and out of place (i.e. unnecessarily). Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Al-Mahm means the liar.”¹³¹ Then Allah says, 4A Hammdz,} Ibn ‘Abbas and Qatadah both said, “This is slander.”¹⁴¹ igoing about with Namtm,} This refers to the one who goes around among people instigating discord between them and carrying tales in order to corrupt relations between people when they are good and pleasant. It is confirmed in the Two

Sahih that Mujahid reported from Tawus that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ once passed by two graves and he said, 'These two are being punished, and they are not being punished.' At-Tabari 23:533. 131 At-Tabari 23:533. 141 At-Tabari 23:534

Jil J* 'r\$ ') js jit jj&f iJZIS ft JS fjlZll Jit *•* ' * ' aShall I inform you of the people of Paradise? (They will be) every weak and oppressed person. When he swears by Allah, he fulfills his oath. Shall I inform you of the people of the Fire? Every 'Utl (cruel person), Jawwdz and arrogant person. »m Al-Wakl' said, "It ('Utl) is every Jawwdz, Ja'zari and arrogant person." Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this in their Two SahOis, as well as the rest of the Group, except for Abu Dawud. All of its routes of transmission are by way of Sufyan Ath-Thawri and Shuhah who both reported it from Said bin Khalid. [2 > The scholars of Arabic language have said that Ja'zari means rude and harsh, while Jawwdz means greedy and stingy. Concerning the word Zanim, Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said concerning the Ayah, i'Utl (cruel), and moreover Zanim.} "A man from the Quraysh who stands out among them like the sheep that has had a piece of its ear cut off."131 The meaning of this is that he is famous for his evil just as a sheep that has a piece of its ear cut off stands out among its sister sheep. In the Arabic language the Zanim is a person who is adopted among a group of people (i.e., he is not truly of them). Ibn Jarir and others among the Imams have said this. Concerning Allah's statement, ft&C iSEH JC h ft J} i(He was so) because he had wealth and children. When Our Ayat are recited to him, he says: "Tales of the men of old!"} Allah is saying, this is how he responds to the favors that 111 Ahmad 5:306. Fath Al-Bari 8 :530 , Muslim 4 :2190 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :33 1 , An- Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:497, and Ibn Majah 2 :1378. I3 * Al-Bukhari no. 4917.

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah has bestowed upon him of wealth and children, by disbelieving in Allah's Ayat and turning away from them while claiming that they are a lie that has been taken from the tales of the ancients.' This is similar to Allah's statement, iLeave Me alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely (without any wealth and children etc.). And then granted him resources in abundance. And children to be by his side. And made life smooth and comfortable for him . After all that he desires that I should give more. Nay! Verily, he has been opposing Our Ayat. I shall oblige him to face a severe torment! Verily, he thought and plotted. So let him be cursed, how he plotted! And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! Then he thought. Then he frowned and he looked in a bad tempered way. Then he turned back, and was proud. Then he said: "This is nothing but magic from that of old, this is nothing but the word of a human being!" I will cast him into Hellfire. And what will make you know what Hellfire is? It spares not (any sinner), nor does it leave (anything unburned)! Burning and blackening the skins! Over it are nineteen (angels as keepers of Hell). [74:11- 30] Then Allah said here, 4We shall brand him on the snout!} Ibn Jarir said, "We will make his matter clear and evident so that they will know him and he will not be hidden from them, just as the branding mark on the snouts (of animals)." Others have said, m At-Tabari 23 :541

IllSurah 68. Nun (17-29) (Part-29) 4We shall brand him This is the mark of the people of the Hell- fire; meaning, We will blacken his face on

the Day of Judge- ment,' and the face has been referred to here as snout. j* ij& kjiL* j >j titj g! T\ ^ o] Eb~ & !>Jit (5jf V ol ir & !K» Cl lj!B Uj\, Q» js jf Srjj £5 J j! -^1 dgii & Cl Ct^» ijli f-fOyyt' 4 , -

TX,oj^*> \jX j) }J\$ l v'Jul' 427. Verily, We have tried them as We tried the People of the Carden, when they swore to pluck thefruits in the morning,} 418. Without (saying: "IfAllah wills.")} 419. Then there passed over it a Td'iffrom your Lord while they were asleep.} 420. So by the morning, it became like As-Sartm.} 421. Then they called out (one to another as soon) as the morning broke.} 422 . Saying : "Go to your tilth in the morning, if you would i3anj& »»» 'mimsm iCjg^ObU?!^lc'(J>Uai^ Oy.V.Sjj jbwul £k(g) .Ai^iw:7.i5l;(hr.i'iL' ^ c _ j]?*? elf i*r""? j3^ &" Cl iCj jiiL yu *4^" £; J1 C[l^i. Uj^ J jfffy pluck (thefruits)."} 423 . So they departed, and they were whispering :} 424. "No poor person shall enter upon you into it today."} 425. And they went in the morning with Hard Qadirin.} 426. But when they saw it, they said: "Verily, we have gone astray."} 427. "Nay! Indeed we are deprived!"} 428. The Awsat among them said; "Did I not tell you, 'Why do you not Tusabbiliun " } 429. They said: "Glory to Our Lord! Verily, we have been wrongdoers."} 430. Then they turned one against another, blaming.} 431. They said: "Woe to us! Verily, we were Taghin."} 432. "We hope that our Lord will give us in exchange better than it. Truly, we hope in our Lord."} 433 . Such is the punishment, but truly, the punishment of the Hereafter is greater ifthey but knew.} A Parable of the Removal of the Earnings of the Disbelievers This is a parable that Allah made of the behavior of the Quraysh disbelievers with the great mercy, and tremendous favors He granted them. The mercy and favor of sending of Muhammad jg to them. But they met him with denial, rejection and opposition. Therefore Allah says, 4&A 4Verily, We have tried them} meaning, *We have tested them.' 4\$&' \£} 4as We tried the People of the Garden,} This refers to a garden containing different types of fruits and vegetation. 4when they swore to pluck the fruits of the (garden) in the morning,}

meaning, they vowed between themselves during the night that they would pluck the fruit of the garden in the morning so that poor and the beggars would not know what they were doing. In this way they would be able to keep its fruit for themselves and not give any of it in charity. ^£,*£1 %} ^Without (saying: "IfAllah wills.")} meaning their vow that they made. Therefore, Allah broke their vow. He then said, >j viljj j* Sfe} iThen there passed over it a Ta'iffrom your Lord while they were asleep.} meaning, it was afflicted with some heavenly destruction. iSo by the morning it became like As-Sarim.} Ibn 'Abbds said, "Like the dark night." 111 Ath-Thawri and As- Suddi both said, "Like the crop when it is harvested withered and dry." iThen they called out (one to another as soon) as the morning broke.} meaning, when it was (early) morning time they called each other so that they could go together to pick the harvest or cut it (its fruits). Then Allah said, Saying :) "Go to your tilth in the morning, if you would pluck (thefruits)."} meaning, 'ifyou want to pluck your harvest fruit.' >> iSo they departed, and they were whispering :} meaning, they spoke privately about what they were doing so 111 At-Tabari 23:544.

124 Tafstr Ibn Kathir that no one could hear what they were saying. Then Allah, the All-Knower of secrets and private discussions, explained what they were saying in private. He said, iSo they departed, and they were whispering : "No poor person shall enter upon you into it today."} meaning, some of them said to others, "Do not allow any poor person to enter upon you in it (the garden) today." Allah then said, 4/s- & iAnd they went in the morning with Hard} meaning, with strength and power. iQadirin} meaning, they thought they had power to do what they claimed and what they were desiring. ci ys &} iBut when they saw it, they said: "Verily, we have gone astray."} meaning, when they arrived at it and came upon it, and it was in the condition which Allah changed from that luster, brilli- ance and

abundance of fruit, to being black, gloomy and void of any benefit. They believed that they had been mistaken in the path they took in walking to it. This is why they said, 4oJu ti} 4Verily, we have gone astray.} meaning, “we have walked down a path other than the one we were seeking to reach it.’ This was said by Ibn ‘Abbas and others. Then they changed their minds and realized with certainty that it was actually the correct path. Then they said, iNay! Indeed we are deprived (of the fruits)!} meaning, ‘nay, this is it, but we have no portion and no share (of harvest).’ 4-(&£

iThe Awsat among them said,} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Kab, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas, Ad- Dahhak and Qatadah all said, “This means the most just of them and the best of them.” 11 J j} }Did I not tell you, ‘Why do you not Tusabbihun?’} Mujahid, As-Suddi and Ibn Jurayj all said that, iWhy do you not Tusabbihun?} this means “why do you not say, *If Allah wills?” ”*21 As-Suddi said, “Their making exception due to the will of Allah in that time was by glorifying Allah (Tasbih).” Ibn Jarir said, “It is a person’s saying, If Allah wills.’ ”,3) It has also been said that it means that the best of them said to them, “Did I not tell you, why don’t you glorify Allah and thank Him for what He has given you and favored you with?” H ’» iThey said: "Glory to Our Lord! Verily, we have been wrongdoers."} They became obedient when it was of no benefit to them, and they were remorseful and confessed when it was not of any use. Then they said, i“... Verily, we have been wrongdoers." Then they turned one against another, blaming.} meaning, they started blaming each other for what they had resolved to do, preventing the poor people from receiving their right of the harvested fruit. Thus, their response to each other was only to confess their error and sin. iThey said: "Woe to us! Verily, we were Taghin."} (1) At-Tabari 23:550. At-Tabari 23 :551 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :253. 131 At-Tabari 23:550.

meaning, “we have transgressed, trespassed, violated and exceeded the bounds until what this happened to us.’ iWe hope that our Lord will give us in exchange better than it. Truly, we hope in our Lord.} It has been said, “They were hoping for something better in exchange in this life.” It has also been said, “They were hoping for its reward in the abode of the Hereafter.” And Allah knows best. Some of the Salaf mentioned that these people were from Yemen. Said bin Jubayr said, “They were from a village that was called Darawan which was six miles from San’a’ (in Yemen).” It has also been said, “They were from the people of Ethiopia whose father had left them this garden, and they were from the People of the Book. Their father used to handle the garden in a good way. Whatever he reaped from it he would put it back into the garden as it needed, and he would save some of it as food for his dependants for the year, and he would give away the excess in charity. Then, when he died, and his children inherited the garden they said, Verily, our father was foolish for giving some of this garden’s harvest to the poor. If we prevent them from it, then we will have more.’ So when they made up their minds to do this they were punished with what was contrary to their plan. Allah took away all of what they possessed of wealth, gain and charity. Nothing remained for them.” Allah then says, iSuch is the punishment,} meaning, such is the punishment of whoever opposes the command of Allah, is stingy with what Allah has given him and favored him with, withholds the right of the poor and needy, and responds to Allah’s blessings upon him with ungratefulness (or disbelief). ibut truly, the punishment of the Hereafter is greater if they but knew.} meaning, this is the punishment in this life, as you have heard, and the punishment of the Hereafter is even harder.

jj slyji lli jS3 fl 'ftddfi u« ^3 6i *j v^C \$? o}^ \$£ i?5i ^ ft 0^ 3& *\$ 4C- ®oj\$2 Q # 434. Verily, for those who have Taqwa are Gardens of Delight with their Lord.} 435. Shall We then treat the Muslims like the criminals?} 436. What is the matter with you? How judge you?} 437. Or have you a Book wherein you leant,} 436. That you shall therein have all that you dwose?} 439. Or have you oaths from Us, lasting until the Day of judgement, that yours will be what you judge?} 440. Ask them, which ofthem will stand as suretyfor that!} 442. Or have they “partners”? Then let them bring their "partners" if they are truthful!} The Reward ofThose Who have Taqwa and that They will not be treated like the Criminals After Allah mentions the situation of the people of the worldly garden and the wrath they suffered when they disobeyed Allah and opposed His command, He then explains that whoever has Taqwa of Him, then they will have Gardens of Delight in the Hereafter that will never end. These Gardens will last forever and their pleasures will never cease. Allah says, iShall We then treat the Muslims like the criminals?} meaning, ‘should We deal equally between them in terms of recompense?’ Nay, by the Lord of the heaven and the earth, surely not! Thus, Allah says, dS% c} iWhat is the matter with you? How do you judge?} meaning, *how can you think that?’ Then He says,

iOr have you a Book wherein you learn that you shall therein have all that you choose?} Allah is saying in this, ‘is there in your hands a Book that has been sent down from heaven that you study, memorize and pass on to each other, the latter generations conveying it from the generations of old? Do you have such a Book, containing definite laws, as you claim?’ ^0 j', iib ££ fi (1 iThat you shall therein have all that you choose? Or have you oaths from Us, lasting until the Day of Judgement, that yours will be what you judge?} meaning, ‘do you have covenants and confirmed agreements with Us?’ ithat yours will be what you judge?} meaning, ‘that you will attain all that you want and desire.’ iAsk them, which of them will stand as surety for that!} meaning, say to them, “Who is the sponsor to guarantee this?” Ibn ‘Abbas said that it means, “Which of them will be a guarantor for that.”111 iOr have they “partners”?} meaning, ‘do they have idols and rivals gods (besides Allah)?’ iThen let them bring their “partners" ifthey are truthful!} \y& j*j At y* o; o* «Jt-So foy Y <L~*- ii 4*^? cej jjj* jb j) />> oi -A+i ^ <^T iij jii iii At-Tabari 23 :554.

442. The Day when the Shin shall be laid bare and they shall be called to prostrate themselves, but they shall not be able to do so.} 443. Their eyes will be cast down and ignominy will cover them; they used to be called to prostrate themselves, while they were> 444. Then leave Me alone with whoever denies this narration. We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not.} 445. And I will grant them a respite. Verily, My plan is strong.} 446. Or is it that you ask them a wage, so that they are lieavily burdened with debt?} 447. Or that the Unseen is in their hands, so that they can write it down?} The Terror ofthe Day ofJudgement After Allah mentions that those who have Taqwa, will have Gardens of Delight with their Lord, He explains when this will be, and its actual occurrence. He says, 4The Day when the Shin shall be laid bare and they shall be called to prostrate themselves, but they shall not be able to do so.} meaning, the Day of Judgement and the horrors, earthquakes, trials, tests and great matters that will occur during it. Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that he heard the Prophet ag saying, j 0’j\$> SyQ t tUJ-j l\jj UjjJl «Onr Lord will reveal His Shin, and every believing male and female will prostrate to Him. The only people who will remain standing are those who prostrated in the worldly life only to be seen and heard (showing off). This type of person will try to prostrate at that time, but his back will made to be one stiff

120 Tafslr Ibn Kathir plate (the bone will not bend or flex).” This Hadith was recorded in the Two Sahihs and other books from different routes of transmission with various wordings. It is a long Hadith that is very popular.* 1 Concerning Allah’s statement, ‘Their eyes will be cast down and ignominy will cover them;’ means, in the final abode, due to their crimes and arrogance in the worldly life. Thus they will be punished with the opposite of what they did. When they were called to prostrate in the worldly life, they refused to do so even though they were healthy and secure. Therefore, they will be punished with the lack of ability to do so in the Hereafter. When the Almighty Lord makes Himself visible (before the believers), then the believers will fall down in prostration to Him, but no one of the disbelievers and hypocrites will be able to prostrate, rather, their backs will become one plate. Everytime one of them attempts to prostrate, he will bow his neck but will not be able to prostrate. This is just like in the life of this world, when these people were in opposition to what the believers were doing. For whoever denies the Qur’an Then Allah says, ‘Then leave Me alone with such as belie this narration.’ meaning, the Qur’an. This is a severe threat which means, leave Me alone with this person; I know about him and how I will gradually punish him and increase him in his falsehood. I am giving him respite for a while, then I will seize him with a mighty and powerful punishment.’ Thus, Allah says, ‘We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not.’ meaning, and they will not even be aware of it. Rather, they *** FathAl-Bari 8:531, 532, and Muslim 1 :167.

121 Surah 68. Nun (42-47) (Part-29) will believe that it is a noble blessing from Allah, but really the same matter is actually a form of humiliation (for them). This is similar to Allah's statement, ‘Do they think that in wealth and children with which We expand them, We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.’ (23:55,56) Allah also said, ‘So, when they forgot that which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of everything, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden. We punished them, and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets and sorrows.’ Therefore, Allah says here, ‘And I will grant them a respite. Verily, My plan is strong.’ meaning, I will delay them, give them respite and extend their time. Yet, this is My plan, and My plot against them.’ Thus, Allah says, ‘Verily, My plan is strong.’ meaning, ‘great against whoever opposes My command, rejects My Messengers and dares to disobey Me.’ In the Two Sahihs it is recorded from the Messenger of Allah ^ that he said, ‘In “Verily Allah the Exalted gives respite to the wrongdoer until He seizes him and he will not be able to escape Him. Then he recited, ‘And I will grant them a respite. Verily, My plan is strong.’’

Such is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.’ (11:102) In reference to Allah’s statement, ‘Or is it that you ask them for a wage, so that they are heavily burdened with debt? Or that the Unseen is in their hands, so that they can write it down?’

the explanation of these two Ayat preceded in Siirat At-Tur)2 ^

The meaning of it is, ‘you, O Muhammad, call them to Allah without taking any wages from them, rather, you hope for the reward with Allah. Yet, they reject that which you have brought to them simply due to ignorance, disbelief and obstinacy.’

£\$Siw\$irt ot */& Jw *5^ aj StyV fi jl ly yCaJid Jj[Sjljij j&l' ij*? Ci >_r-4{ <(48. So, toflif wif/i patience for the decision of your Lord, and be not like the Companion of the Fish when he cried out (to Us) while he was Makziim.)} 1 Fath. Al-Bari 8 :205 , and Muslim 4 :1997 ' See volume nine , the Tafsirof Surat At-Tur (52 :40)

449. Had not a grace from his Lord reached him, he would indeed have been (left in the stomach of thefish, but Weforgave him), so he was cast offon the naked shore, while he was to be blamed.} 450. Then his Lord chose him and made him of the righteous.4 451 . And verily, those who disbelieve would almost make you slip with their eyes (through hatred) when they hear the Reminder (the Qur'an), and they say: "Verily, he is a madman!"} 452 . But it is nothing else than a Reminder to all the creatures ('Alamin).} The Command to be Patient and to refrain from being Hasty like Yunus was Allah says, 4So wait with patience 'O Muhammad, persevere against the harm your people cause you and their rejection. For verily, Allah will give you authority over them, and make the final victory foryou and your followers in this life and the Hereafter.' 4&fo %} 4and be not like the Companion of the Fish} meaning, Dhun-Nun, who was Yunus bin Matta, when hewent off angry with his people. Various things happened to him, such as riding on a ship at sea, being swallowed by a (large) fish, the fish carrying him off into the ocean, being in the darkness and depth of the sea arid hearing the sea's and its dwellers glorification of the Most High, the Most Able (Allah). For He (Allah) is the One Whose execution of divine decree cannot be resisted. After all of this, he (Yunus) called out from the layers of darkness, Yl Y J} 4"That none has the right to be worshipped but You (O Allah), Glorified (and- Exalted) are You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers."} (21:87) Then Allah said concerning him,

' A /%£<•" >| ot fi \$So We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress. And thus We do deliver the believers.} (21:88) Allah also says, iHad he not been of them who glorify Allah, he would have indeed remained inside its belly (thefish) till the Day when they are resurrected.} (37:143,144) So here (in this Surah), Allah says, jb «&b iwhen he cried out (to Us) while he was Makzum.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and As-Suddi, all said, "while he was distressed." 111 Then Allah goes on to say, iThen his Lord chose him and made him of the righteous.} Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Abdullah that the Messenger of Allah Ss said, 'eT* Oi J?~ ^ :JjZ ji o>-S/ ilt is not befitting for anyone to say that I am better than Yunus bin Matta.ffi Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith * and it is in the Two Sahths reported from Abu Hurayrah.141 Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd verily, those who disbelieve would almost make you slip with their eyes} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others have said. 111 Al-Tabari 23:563. 121 Ahmad 1 :390. 131 Fath Al-B&ri 6:519 . . Fath Al-B&ri8 :144 , and Muslim 4 :1846

iwould make you slip} "In order to have some effect on you.",1 > iwith their eyes} meaning, "they will affect you by looking at you with their eyes (i.e., the evil eye).' This means 'they are jealous of you due to their hatred of you, and were it not for Allah's protection of you, defending you against them (then their evil eye would harm you).' The Effect ofthe Evil Eye is Real In this Ayah is a proof that the effect of the evil eye and its affliction by the command of Allah is real. Many Hadiths have been reported concerning this through numerous routes of transmission. The Hiadith ofBuraydah binAl-Husayb Abu 'Abdullah bin Majah recorded from Buraydah bin Al- Hu\$ayb that the Messenger of Allah said, '4j^ "There is no Ruqyah121 except to cure the evil eye and the sting.i This is how Ibn Majah recorded this Hadith. Imam Muslim also recorded this Hadith in his Sahih on the authority of Buraydah himself, but

he did not attribute it to the Prophet There is a story concerning this incident (as reported by Buraydah in Sahih Muslim),¹⁴ and At-Tirmidhi recorded the Hadith in this manner (like Muslim's version).¹⁵ This Hadith has also been recorded by Imam Al-Bukhari, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi on the authority of 'Imran bin Husayn, however, / he did not attribute it to the Prophet Imran's wording is, in At-Tabari 23 :564,565. ' Prayer formula for healing. •3| Ibn Majah 2:1161. 141 Muslim 1 :199. ' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi6:217.

'There is no Ruqyah except to cure the evil eye and the stingy '* 11 Muslim recorded in his Sahih from Ibn 'Abbas that the Prophet ﷺ said, '«The evil eye is real. If anything were to overtake the divine decree (and change it), that it would be the evil eye. And if you perform Ghusl (to remove the evil eye) then wash it.»(21 Muslim was alone in recording this Hadith, as Al-Bukhari did not mention it. It is reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to invoke Allah's protection for Al-Hasan and Al-Husayn (his grandsons) by saying, '«I seek protection for you two by the perfect Words of Allah from every Shaytan, and dangerous creature, and from every eye that is evil .»' Then he would say: "Thus, did Ibrahim used to seek protection for Ishaq and Isma'il (his sons)»' This Hadith was recorded by Al-Bukhari and the Sunan compilers. ,3) The Hadith of Abu Umamah As'ad bin Sahl bin Hunayf Ibn Majah recorded from Abu Umamah As'ad bin Sahl bin Hunayf that 'Amir bin Rab'ah passed by Sahl bin Hunayf while he was bathing and he said, "I haven't seen the skin of a beautiful virgin girl nicer than this that I see today (i.e., 111 Fath Al-Bari 10:163, Abu Dawud 4:213, and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi Muslim 4 :1719. 3| Fath Al-Bari 6:470, Abu Dawud 5:104, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:220, An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :250 , and Ibn Majah 2 : 1 164

commenting on how nice Sahl's skin was)." So he did not leave before he (Sahl) fell down on the ground. So he was brought to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and it was said to him (the Prophet ﷺ) that Sahl had been afflicted by a seizure. The Prophet ﷺ then said, «? "Who do you blame (or hold responsible) for this? The people replied, "Amir bin Rab'ah." Then the Prophet ﷺ said, "5^4 ^ *~f' Irf iJsb lj) ?JU-i "Would one of you knowingly kill his brother? If one of you sees something of his brother that he likes, then let him supplicate for blessings for him. Then the Prophet ﷺ called for some water and he commanded 'Amir to perform Wudu' with the water. So he washed his face, his hands up to his two elbows, his two knees, and the inside of his Izar. Then the Prophet ﷺ commanded him to pour the water over Sahl. Sufyan said that Ma'mar related from Az-Zuhri that he said, "The Prophet ﷺ ordered him to turn the water pot over (empty its contents over) him (Sahl) from behind him." 111 An-Nasab recorded this Hadith through different routes from Abu Umamah with the wording, "And he turned the pot over pouring its contents over him (Sahl) from behind him." 121 The Hadith of Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri Ibn Majah recorded that Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri said, "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to seek refuge from the evil eye of the Jinns and the evil eye of humans. Then when the Mu'awwidhatan were revealed, he used them (for seeking protection) and abandoned everything else." 141 This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi, and An-Nasab. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan."*51 Sunan Ibn Majah no . 3509 * An-Nasab in Al-Kubra no. 7617-7619. Surat At-Falq (113) and Surat An-Nas (114). Ibn Majah 2:1161 ,S| TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :218 , and An-Nasab 8 :271

Another Hadith from Abu Sa'id • Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Said that Jibril came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, "O Muhammad, are you suffering from any ailment?" The Prophet ﷺ said, "Yes." Then Jibril said, "In the Name of Allah I pray over you for healing (Ruqyah), from everything that bothers you, from the evil of every soul and every evil eye that hates you, may Allah cure you, in the Name of Allah I pray over you for healing." This Hadith has been recorded by Muslim and the Sunan compilers except for Abu Dawud. Imam Ahmad also recorded from Abu Said or Jabir bin 'Abdullah that the Messenger of Allah was bothered by some illness, and Jibril came to him and said, "In the Name of Allah I pray over you for healing (Ruqyah), from everything that bothers you, from every envious person and evil eye, may Allah cure you." [3] The Hadith of Abu Hurayrah Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Verily the evil eye is real." [4] Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this Hadith as well. [11] Ahmad 3:28,56. [2] Muslim 4:1718, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:46, and An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :249 , and Ibn Majah 2 : 1164 Ahmad 3:58, 75. [14] Ahmad 2:319. [15] Path Al-Bdri 10:213, and Muslim 4:1719.

129 Surah 68. Nun (48-52) (Part-29) Ibn Majah recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "The evil eye is real." Ibn Majah was alone in recording this Hadith. The Hadith of Asma' bint 'Umayy al-Muhibbi Imam Ahmad recorded from "Ubayd bin Rifa'ah Az-Zuraqi that Asma' said, "O Messenger of Allah! Verily, Bani Israhil are afflicted with the evil eye; should I seek to have Ruqyah?" The Prophet ﷺ replied, "Yes, for if anything could overcome the divine decree, it would be the evil eye." [12] This Hadith has been recorded like this by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, and An-Nasab. At-Tirmidhi said concerning it, "Hasan Sahih." [13] The Hadith of 'A'ishah Ibn Majah recorded from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ordered her to have Ruqyah performed as a cure against the evil eye. [14] This was reported by Al-Bukhari and Muslim [15] The Hadith of Sahl bin Hunayf Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Umamah bin Sahl bin Hunayf that his father informed him that the Messenger of Allah went out on a journey in the direction of Makkah and they (the Companions) accompanied him until they came to the valley of Kharrar from Al-Juhfah. They stopped there and [11] Ibn MSjah 2:1159. Alunad 6 :438 * Tuhfat Al-Ahuiadhi6 :219 , and Ibn Majah 2:1160. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi6 :220 [16] Ibn Majah 2:1161. Fath Al-Bari 10:210, and Muslim 4 :1725

using coverings (to cover their nakedness). So 'Amir removed a cloak of wool that he (Sahl) was using to conceal himself. He ('Amir) said, 'I looked at him and my eye fell upon him while he was pouring water on himself bathing. Then I heard a loud splash in the water coming from where he was. So I went to him, and I called him three times, but he did not answer me. So I went to the Prophet ﷺ and informed him. Then, the Prophet ﷺ came walking, and he was wading in the water. I can still picture the whiteness of his shins, when he came to Sahl (who was unconscious), he hit him on his chest with his hand and said, "O Allah! Remove from him its heat, its cold and its pain." He (Sahl) then stood up, and Allah's Messenger said, "If one of you sees in his brother, or himself, or his wealth that which pleases him, then he should ask Allah to bless it, for verily, the evil eye is real." [1] The Accusation of the Disbelievers and the Reply to Them Allah says, "and they say: 'Verily, he is a madman!'" meaning, they cut at him with their eyes and attack him with their tongues saying, "Verily, he is a madman." They say this because he came with the Qur'an. Allah then says, "But

it is nothing else but a Reminder to all the creatures ('Alamin).} This is the end of the explanation (Tafsii of Surah Nun (or Al-Qalam), and all praise and blessing belong to Allah. 111 Ahmad 3:447.

Surah 69: Al-Haqqah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6078–6099

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6078–6081]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. && %J ip 0M C J*-* ('Jt'® i-Je igft & e? *3 s* £ %& pe itp^ <3 »ji3 jvjrJ J>-j Pppj p crj i>pA *tj JiSiC £#£5\$ Si ~Qj '<££ j3 @,0' a jSE- £n a' Q%0t& 41 . Al-Haqqah!} 42. WTiflf is Al-Haqqah?} <3 . And what will make you know what Al-Haqqah is?} <4. Thamiid and 'Ad denied the Qdri'ah!} <5. Asfor Thamiid, they were destroyed by the Taghiyah!} <6. And as for 'Ad, they were destroyed by a wind, Sarsar 'Atiyah!} 47. Which Allah imposed on them for seven nights and eight days Husum, so that you could see men lying toppled, as if they were trunks of date palms, Khawiyah!} 48. Do you see any remnants of them?} 49- And Fir'awn, and those before him, ynd the cities overthrown committed Al-Khati'ah.} 410. And they disobeyed their Lord's Messenger, so He seized them with a punishment that was Rdbiyah.} <22. Verily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the ship.} <22. That We might make it an admonition for you and that it

133Surah 69. Al-Haqqah (1-12) (Part-29) might be retained by the retaining ears.}

Warning concerning the Greatness of the Day of Judgement Al-Haqqah is one of the names of the Day of Judgement, because during it the promise and the threat will inevitably occur. Due to this, Allah has declared the greatness of this matter. So He says, iAnd what will make you know what Al-Haqqah is?} Mention of the Destruction of the Nations Then Allah mentions the destruction of the nations that denied the Resurrection. He says, <\$Asfar Thamiid, they were destroyed by the Tdghiyah!} It is the ciy which will silence them, and the quake that will silence them. Qatadah said similar to this when he said, “At-Taghiyah is the shout.” * Mujahid said, “At-Taghiyah means the sins.” This was also said by Ar-Rabx‘ bin Anas and bin Zayd. They said that it means transgression. After mentioning this, Ibn Zayd recited the following Ayatas proof for his statement, iThamud denied through their transgression .} Then Allah says, iAnd asfar 'Ad, they were destroyed by a wind Sarsar meaning, a cold wind. Qatadah, As-Suddi, Ar-Rabl‘ bin Anas and Ath-Thawri all said about, i'Atiyah} “This means severe blowing of the wind.” Qatadah said, “It m At-Tabari 23 :571

4Khdwiyah} “It means ruined.” Others besides him said, “It means dilapidated.” This means that the wind would cause one of them (palm tree) to hit the ground, and it will fall down dead on his head. Then his head would shatter and it would remain a lifeless corpse as if it were without branches, motionless. It has been confirmed in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ijj,jjL lu Jia;vj ckii «/ was helped by an easterly wind and the people of 'Ad were destroyed by a westerly windM 1 ^ 4Do you see any remnants of them?} meaning, ‘do you find any one of them left or anyone who even

attributes himself to being from them?’ Rather they are all gone, right down to the last of them, and Allah did not make for them any successors. Then Allah says, 4 j’j 4And Fir’awn and those before him committed (sin)} This has been recited with a Kasrah under the letter Qaf (in the word Qabalah, as Qiblah), which changes the meaning to those who were with him in his time, and they were his followers who were disbelieving Coptic people. Others recited it with a Fathah over the letter Qaf (as the word Qabla.h), which means those nations before him who were similar to him. Concerning Allah’s statement, 4the overthrown cities} those nations that rejected their Messengers. 4committed Al-Khati’ah.} Al-Khati’ah means their rejection of

what Allah revealed. Ar-Rabi‘ said.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6081–6099]

111 Muslim 2:617.

236 Tafsir Ibn Kathir icommitted Al-Khati’ah.} “This means disobedience.” Mujahid said, “They committed errors.” Thus, Allah says, 4And they disobeyed their Lord's Messenger,} meaning they were all of the same type, they all denied the Messenger of Allah who was sent to them. As Allah says, 4Everyone of them denied the Messengers, so My threat took effect.} So whoever denies a Messenger, then verily, he denies all of the Messengers. This is as Allah says, iThe people ofNuh belied the Messengers} 4Ad belied the Messengers.} iThamiid belied the Messengers.} However, only one Messenger came to every nation. Thus, Allah says here, '(np JAj !^} 4And they disobeyed their Lord's Messenger, so He seized them with a punishment that was Rabiyyah.} Rabiyyah means, great, severe and painful. Mujahid said, “Rabiyyah means severe. ' As-Suddi said, “It means destructive.” At-Tabari 23:576. At-Tabari 23:577.

137Surah 69. Al-Hdqqah (1-12) (Part-29) A Reminder about the Blessing ofthe Ship Then, Allah says, 4fi'& 6 \} iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, meaning, it rose up over its shores by the leave of Allah and it overcame all that existed. Ibn ‘Abbas and others said, “The water rising beyond its boundary means it increased abundantly.” * This happened due to the supplication of Nuh against his people when they denied him, opposed him and worshipped other than Allah. Therefore, Allah answered his supplication and the people of the earth were covered with the flood except for those who were with Nuh in the ship. Thus, are humans all from the loins of NQh and his progeny. For this reason Allah reminds humanity of His blessing, 4 j iQl lit UJ iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the ship.} meaning, a ship running along upon the surface of the water. iThat We might make it an admonition for you The pronoun “it” here refers to the species of the object (ships) due to the general meaning alluding to this. Thus, the meaning is, *We caused its type of creation (ships) to remain (in the earth) for you, so that you ride upon the currents of the water in the seas.’ This is as Allah says, 'H *-*£ *4^2 _*i lyi-iJ 1* irt& J**j} iand has appointedfar you ships and cattle on which you ride; In order that you may mount on their backs, and then may remember the favor of your Lord when you mount thereon} (43:12,13) m At-Tabari 23 :577

139Surah 69. Al-Hdqqah (13-18) (Part-29) 415. Then on that Day shall the Event occur. 416. And the heaven will be rent asunder, for that Day it ivill befrail and tom up.} 417. And the angels will be on its

sides, and eight angels will, that Day, bear the Throne of your Lord above them.} 418. That Day shall you be brought to Judgement, not a secret of you will be hidden.} A Mention of the Horrors of the Day of Judgement Allah informs of the horrors that will take place on the Day of Judgement. The first of these events is the blowing of fright (into the Trumpet), which will be followed by the blowing of destruction when everyone in the heavens and the earth will be struck down except whoever Allah wills. Then, after this will be the blowing of standing before the Lord 'of all that exists, and the resurrection, and the gathering. And this is that blowing.¹¹¹ It is emphasized here that it is one blowing, because the command of Allah cannot be opposed or prevented, and it does not need to be repeated or stressed. Thus, Allah goes on to say, . & so\$ j.jf\afj} 4And the earth and the mountains shall be removed from their places, and crushed with a single crushing.} meaning, they will be stretched out to the extent of the surface (of the earth) and the earth will change into something else other than the earth. 4Then on that Day shall the Event occur.} meaning, the Day of Judgement. 4 -jf. ^3} I 1 ' The majority of scholars say that there are two times the Trumpet is blown. The saying that there are three is based upon unauthentic narrations as explained earlier. See volume seven, the Tafsir of Surat An-Naml (27 : 87) and the discussion following it

4And the heaven will be rent asunder, for that Day it will be frail and torn up.} Ibn Jurayj said, "This is like Allah's statement, 4f\$c\$ tfar ^4;} 4And the heaven shall be opened, it will become as gates.} (78:19) Ibn 'Abbas said, "It (the sky) will be torn apart and the Throne will be heard in it." <W& 4And the angels will be on its sides,} The word Malak here is referring to the species of angels (all of them); meaning the angels collectively will be standing on the sides of the heavens. Ar-Rabl' bin Anas said concerning Allah's statement, \$ &a\j} 4And the angels will be on its sides,} "This means that they will be standing on what has been ground to powder of the heavens looking at the people of the earth." Concerning the statement of Allah, 4% m 4and eight angels will, that Day, bear the Throne of your Lord above them.} means, on the Day of Judgement eight angels will carry the Throne. Abu Dawud recorded from Jabir bin 'Abdullah that the Messenger of Allah gg said, U jl <il *&y* j* lilU Ifr jl ^ oil </ was permitted to speak about one of the angels among those angels who carry the Throne of Allah . Between the lobe of his ear to his shoulder is the distance of seven hundred years (of travelling) .» This is the wording recorded by Abu Dawud. !M Abu Dawud 5:96.

The Children of Adam being presented before Allah Concerning the statement of Allah, iThat Day shall you be brought to Judgement, not a secret of you will be hidden .} meaning, "you will all be presented to the Knower of the secrets and private counsels. He is the One from Whom none of your affairs are hidden. He is the Knower of all things apparent, secret and hidden.' This is the reason that Allah says, inot a secret of you will be hidden .} Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Musa that the Messenger of Allah sg said, l jut jl l*(i toL iiUiJl fji HaJLZj *fg£, Jbj-U "jSu X*i JilliJl uThe people will be exhibited three times on the Day of Judgement. The first two presentations will be (their) arguing and offering excuses. During the third presentation the pages (records) will fly into their hands. Some of them will receive the records in their right hands and some will receive them in their left handsJ Ibn Majah and At-Tirmidhi¹¹¹ both recorded this Hadith. 'A* *** it -A/) Cj £&» j£i»j Ijlf ^ £}•» « £?a) s % 4 frt 4 419. Then as for him who will be given his Record in his right hand will say : "Here! read my Record!"} 420. "Surely, I did believe that I shall meet my account!"} I 1 * Ahmad4:414, Ibn

Majah2:1430 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:111. This is narrated from Al-Hasan Al-Basri whom most of the scholars say did not hear from Abu Musd, so according to the majority, it is a disconnected narration.

421. So, he shall be in a life, well-pleasing. 422. In a lofty Paradise,} 423. The fruits in bunches whereof zwill be low and near at hand.} 424. Eat and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!} The Happiness ofthe PersonWho will receive His Book in His Right Hand and His Good Situation Allah informs of the happiness of those who receive their Book in the right hand on the Day ofJudgement and being pleased with this. Out of his extreme pleasure is his saying to everyone that he meets, 4Here! read my Record!} meaning, “take my Book and read it.’ He will say this because he knows that what is in it is good and purely virtuous deeds. He will be of those whom Allah replaced their bad deeds (evils) with good deeds. ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said, “The meaning of 4Here! read my Record!} is ‘Here, read my Book.’... The suffix ‘C/m’ is a grammatical addition.” This is what he (‘Abdur-Rahman) said. It seems apparent that the suffix ‘C/m’ means here you all.’ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that ‘Abdullah bin ‘Abdullah bin Hanzalah - and he (Hanzalah) was the Companion who was washed by the angels for his funeral - said, “Verily, Allah will stop His servant on the Day of Judgement and He will make his sins appear on the outside of his Book of Records. Then He will say to him, “Did you do this?’ The servant will respond, “Yes my Lord.’ Then Allah will say to him, *1 will not expose you (or dishonor you) for it, for verily, I have forgiven you.’ The person will then say, ‘Here (you all) read my Book!’ ” 4Surely, I did believe that I shall meet my account!}

143Surah 69. Al-Hdqqah (19-24) (Part-29) This will be when he (the servant of Allah) will be saved from being disgraced and exposed on the Day of Judgement. In the Sahih, it is recorded from Ibn TJmar that he was asked about the private counsel. He responded by saying that he heard the Messenger of Allah sg saying. 4ll JIS JjULa .ii iil Jj lij i {Ji -4*^ Uij UJjJl ^j> »illIp I «4CruHil' Jc Jil vAllah will bring the servant close (to Him) on the Day of Judgement and make him confess all of his sins. This will continue until the servant thinks that he is about to be destroyed. Then Allah will say, "Verily, I have concealed these sinsfor you in the worldly life and 1 haveforgiven you for them today." Then he will be given his Book of good deeds in his right hand. However, about the disbeliever and the hypocrite, the witnesses will say, 4"These are those who lied on their Lord, and verily, the curse of Allah is on the wrongdoers Allah’s statement, iji iSurely, I did believe that I shall meet my account!} means, T used to be certain in the worldly life that this day would definitely come.’ This is as Allah says, i>4u (4^ dj& 4(They are tlwse) who are certain that they are going to meet their Lord.} (2:46) Allah then says, 4 >4* 4 4So he shall be in a life, well-pleasing.} (69:21) meaning, pleasant. il ££& Ahmad 2 :74, Al-Bukhari 4685, and Muslim 1768.

iln a lofty Paradise,} meaning, having elevated castles, beautiful wide-eyed maidens, pleasant stations and eternal joy. It has been confirmed in the SahOi that the Prophet jfi said, «Verily, Paradise has one hundred levels and between each level is a distance like the distance between the earth and the s/h/V Then Allah says, 4 'ftl }Thefruits in bunches whereofwill be low and near at hand.} Al-Bara’ bin ‘Azib said, “This means close enough for one of them (the people of Paradise) to reach them while he is lying on his bed.”12 * More than one person has said this. Then Allah says. M it ^ \$} 4Eat and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!} meaning, this will be said to them as an invitation to them of blessing, favor and goodness. For verily, it has been confirmed in the Sahih that

the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said. $\text{d>-Jb jjJ jt j t IjjjISj Ijjju-j \jLL\&U <*Work deeds, strive, seek to draw near (to Allah) and know that none of you will be admitted into Paradise because of his deeds. They (the Companions) said, "Not even you O Messenger of Allah?" He replied, (41)1 <jf Nj Uf Vj\® «Nof even me, except if Allah covers me with mercy from Himself and grace. «*3 111 Al-Bukhari no . 2790. [2] At-Jabari 23:586. 131 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :300}$

145 Surah 69. Al-Haaqah (25-37) (Part-29 J iibLl \j ,4_j •S--&' II^jt iollj)lfoa«5j0-4 {b ^JUiTo^s—^y A^Scyljft^ijijJJ^lllj, jg^J&' A-^y'^KI^hjpUI^U^yQp 1 *trN>^>V <^4*^ < f> *'•" X *X Iv^j^yA^AoiLL-^iiijA^aJU^ -,?is^>^I*'frijy 'i' ^ ^ , r . '-*,<\$5* .-4 ^ayvO-lilcljiO jA__L*jyR3 Oji-j \$ j&fcfgj l£\$Sf j£^uj y &>} £ ii ^ :) \$\$>. Si> ^ ^ AS\$# yji- |ffj«.:J»l- ii«- 4U • 'l *>;i.>i_ . .»« J > -J,*/- y .^.,yW 6ji Sjiip • <L_L Z& v ^ \$ @yja:ti fM» ^ i^b* 1?j ^,^bJ' l-4> pjK 4J jjJi* l^jty£{!CilJ' i^ . ft (j^t % •if}y 'ft #t -i •^y-“ 425. But as for him who will be given his Record in his left hand, will say: “I wish that I had not been given my Record!”} 426. “And that I had never known how my account is!”} 427. “Would that it had been my end!”} 428. “My wealth has not availed me;”} 429. “My power has gone from me!”} 430. (It will be said): “Seize him and fetter him;”} “Then throw him in the blazing Fire.”} 432. “Then fasten him on a chain whereof the length is seventy cubits!”} 433. Verily, he used not to believe in Allah, the Most Great,} 434. And urged not the feeding of the poor.} 435. So, no friend has he here this Day,} 436. Nor any food except filth from Ghisl in.}

437 . None will eat it except the Khati'fm .) The Bad Condition of Whoever is given His Record in His Left Hand These Ayat inform about the condition of the wretched people when one of them is given his Record (of deeds) in his left hand when the people are brought before Allah. At this time he will be very remorseful. r'J'i o' 4(He) will say: "I wish that I had not been given my Record! And that I had never known how my account is! Would that it had been my end!..." Ad-Dahhak said, “Meaning a death which is not followed by any life.” Likewise said Muhammad bin Ka*b, Ar-Rabi' and As- Suddi. Qatadah said, “He will hope for death even though in the worldly life it was the most hated thing to him.” 4My wealth has not availed me; my power has gone from me.) means, ‘my wealth and my honor did not protect me from the punishment of Allah and His torment. Now the matter has ended with me alone and I have no helper nor anyone to save me.’ At this Allah says, iSeize him and fetter him ; then throw him in the blazing Fire.) meaning, He will command the guardians of Hell to forcibly remove him from the gathering place, fetter him - meaning put iron collars on his neck - then carry him off to Hell and cast him into it, meaning they will submerge him in it. Allah said, iik/.phl tiji i£Ti j 4Then fasten him on a chain whereof the length is seventy cubits!) m At-Jabari 23 :587.

147 Siirah 69. Al-Hdqqah (25-37) (Part-29) Ka“b Al-Ahbar said, “Every ring of it will be equal to the entire amount of iron found in this world.” Al-‘Awfi reported that Ibn ‘Abbas and Ibn Jurayj both said, “Each cubit will be the forearm’s length of an angel.” ' Ibn Jurayj reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, iTheti fasten him “It will be entered into his buttocks and pulled out of his mouth. Then they will be arranged on this * (chain) just like locusts are arranged on a stick that is being roasted.” Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “It will be ran into his behind until it is brought out of his two nostrils so he will not be able to stand on his two feet.”¹² ' Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr that the Messenger of Allah said, frlULil cJLji — jLilj — aJLa jl jjn j\ M jj j0vj jdji CL> oju jjLiui O- “// a drop of lead like this - and he pointed to a skidl bone - were sent from the heaven to the earth, and it is a

distance of five hundred years travel, it would reach the earth before night. And if it (the same drop of lead) were sent from the head of the chain (of Hell), it would travel forty fall seasons, night and day, before it would reach its (Hell's) cavity or fosse.' At-Tirmidhi also recorded this Hadith and he said, "This Hadith is Hasan." Concerning Allah's statement, 'Verily, he used not to believe in Allah, the Most Great, and urged not on the feeding of the poor.' meaning, he did not establish the right of Allah upon him, of obedience to Him and performing His worship. He also did not benefit Allah's creation nor did he give them their rights. For 111 At-Tabari 23:589. 121 At-Tabari 23 :589 131 Ahmad 2:197. 141 TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7:313.

149 Surah 69. Al-Haqqah (39-43) (Part-29 remember 19 443. This is the revelation sent down from the Lord of all that exists. The Qur'an is the Speech of Allah Allah swears by His creation, in which some of His signs can be seen in His creatures. These also indicate the perfection of His Names and Attributes. He then swears by the hidden things that they cannot see. This is an oath swearing that the Qur'an is His Speech, His inspiration and His revelation to His servant and Messenger, whom He chose to convey His Message, and the Messenger carried out this trust faithfully. So Allah says, 'So I swear by whatsoever you see, and by whatsoever you see not, that this is verily the word of an honored Messenger.' meaning, Muhammad jg. Allah gave this description to him, a description which carries the meaning of conveying, because the duty of a messenger is to convey from the sender. Therefore, Allah gave this description to the angelic Messenger in Surat At-Takwim, where he said, 'Verily, this is the Word of (this Qur'an brought by) a most honorable messenger. Owner of power (and high rank) with Allah, the Lord of the Throne. Obeyed and trustworthy.' (81:19-21) And here, it refers to Jibril. Then Allah says, 'And your companion is not a madman. (81:22) meaning, Muhammad 4 And indeed he saw him in the clear horizon. (81:23) meaning, Muhammad saw Jibril in his true form in which Allah created him. 'And M V>9

252 Surah 69. Al-Haqqah (44-52) (Part-29) 445. We surely would have seized him by his right hand,} 446. And then We certainly would have cut off Al-Watin from him,} 447. And none of you could have prevented it from him.} 448. And verily, this is a Reminder for those who have Taqwa.} 449. And verily, We know that there are some among you that deny.} 450. And indeed it will be an anguish for the disbelievers. 451. And verily, it (this Qur'an) is an absolute truth with certainty.} 452. So, glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most Great.} If the Prophet^ forged anything against Allah, then Allah would punish Him Allah says, 'And if he had forged a false saying concerning Us,} meaning, 'if Muhammad forged something against Us, as they claim, and added or removed anything from the Message, or said anything from himself while attributing it to Us, then We would surely be swift in punishing him. And of course, Muhammad did not do any of this (as the disbelievers claimed).' Thus, Allah says. 'We surely would have seized him by his right hand,} It has been said that this means, 'We would seize him by the right hand because it is more stronger in grabbing.' ^ y} 4 And then We certainly would have cut off Al-Watin from him,} Ibn 'Abbas said, "It (Al-Watiri) refers to the artery of the heart, />£} i And indeed it (this Qur'an) will be an anguish for the disbelievers (on the Day of Resurrection).} Ibn Jarir said, "And verily this rejection will be anguish for the disbelievers on the Day of Judgement." 11 ' He (Ibn Jarir) also mentioned a similar statement from Qatadah.' 2 ' It is possible that the meaning of the pronoun (it) may also refer to the Qur'an, in which case the verse would mean that

the Qur'an and belief in it are a cause of anguish for the disbelievers. This is as Allah says, {Thus have We caused it (the denial of the Qur'an) to enter the hearts of the criminals. They will not believe in it.} (26:200,201) And Allah said, {And a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire} (34:54). Therefore, Allah says here, {And verily, it (this Qur'an) is an absolute truth with certainty.} meaning, the right and truthful news in which there is no doubt, suspicion or confusion. Then Allah says, {So glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most Great.} meaning, He Who sent down this magnificent Qur'an. This is the end of the explanation {Tafsir} of Surat Al-Haqqah. And to Allah belong all praise and blessings. At-Tabari 23:595. 121 At-Tabari 23:595.

Surah 70: Al-Maarij

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6100–6102]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Sa'ata Sa'it" (Chapter - 70) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ^{gs} * * « A &'<*w* «** > <1 . A questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall > 42. Upon the disbelievers, which none can avert 43 . From Allah, the Lord of the ways of ascent 44 The angels and the Ruh ascend to Him in a Day the measure whereof is fifty thousand years 45. So be patient, with a good patience 46. Verily, they see it (the torment) afar off 47 . But We see it near A Request to hasten the Day of Judgement y'-n 4a questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall > This Ayah contains an assumed meaning that is aU^ded to i- 4-u "fin" It is as though it is saying, a questioner requested to hasten on the torment that is about to fall. It is similar to Allah's statement, 4Yj^j «i' Jdfc Jj 111 This Surah is commonly referred to as Al-Ma'arij.

iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment! And Allah fails not His promise .> (22:47) meaning, that its torment will occur and there is no avoiding it. Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas concerning the Ayah, iA questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall "That is the questioning of the disbelievers about the torment of Allah and it will occur to them."111 Ibn Abi Najih reported from Mujahid that he said concerning Allah's statement 4% 'sc} iA questioner asked}, "A person called out (requesting) for the torment that will occur in the Hereafter to happen." Then he said, "This is their saying, A it 40 Allah! If this is indeed the truth from you, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment.y™ (8:32) Allah's statement. 42^4 iabout to befall (Waqi) upon tlte disbelievers, means, it is waiting in preparation for the disbelievers. Ibn 'Abbas said, "Waqi' means coming." iwhich non can avert} meaning, there is no one who can repel it if Allah wants it to happen. Thus, Allah says, 4>fQnfSSA\ **i\$ oi} iFrom Allah, the Lord of the ways of ascent (Al-iAa'arij).} At-Tabari 23:599. At-Tabari 23 :599

The Tafsir of "Lord of the ways of ascent"

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6102]

'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "Lord of the ways of ascent means loftiness and abundance." * Mujahid said, "Lord of the ways of ascent means the ways of ascension into the heavens."*2 * Concerning Allah's statement, iThe angels and the Ruh Ta'ruju to Him 'Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ma'mar from Qatadah that Ta'ruju means to ascend. In reference to the Ruh, Abu Salih said, "They are creatures from the creation of Allah that resemble humans but they are not humans." It could be that here it means Jibril, and this is a way of connecting the specific to the general (other

angels). It could also be referring to the name of the souls (Arwah) of the Children of Adam (humans). For verily, when they (the human souls) are taken at death, they are lifted up to the heavens just as the Hadith of Al-Bara' proves.*3

The Meaning of "a Day the measure whereof is fifty

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6102–6107]

thousand years” Concerning Allah’s statement, in a Day the measure whereof is fifty thousand years.} This refers to the Day of Judgement. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said concerning the Ayah, Jil J *y_ J} in a Day the measure whereof is fifty thousand years> “It is the Day of Judgement.” The chain of narration of this report (tb Ibn ‘Abbas) is authentic. Ath-Thawri reported from Simak bin Harb from ‘Ikrimah that he said concerning this verse, “It is the Day of Judgement.”*4 * Ad-Dahhak and Ibn [1 * At-Tabari 23 :600 ' At-Tabari 23:600. * At-Tiwal by At-Tabarani no. 238. The Hadith of Al-Bara' is also recorded by Abu Dawud and others ' At-Tabari 23:601.

157 Surah 70. Sa'ala Sa'il (1-7) (Part-29) Zayd both said the same. ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas concerning the Ayah, iThe angels and the Ruh ascend to Him in a Day the measure whereof is fifty thousand years .> “It is the Day of Judgement that Allah has made to be the measure of fifty thousand years for the disbelievers.”m Many Hadiths have been reported with this same meaning. Imfim Ahmad recorded from Abu Umar Al-Ghudani that he said, “I was with Abu Hurayrah when a man from Bani ‘Amir bin Sa'sa'ah passed and it was said: This man is the wealthiest man of Bani ‘Amir.’ So Abu Hurayrah said, ‘Bring him back to me.’ So they brought the man back to Abu Hurayrah. Then Abu Hurayrah said, “I have been informed that you are a man of great wealth.’ The man from Bani ‘Amir replied, *¥68, by Allah. I have one hundred red-colored camels, one hundred brown-colored camels...’ and so on he counted numerous colored camels, the races of the slaves and the types of fetters for his horses that he owned. So Abu Hurayrah said, “Beware of the hooves of the camels and the cloven hooves of the cattle.’ He continued repeating that to him until the color of the man began to change. Then the man said, ‘O Abu Hurayrah what is this?’ Abu Hurayrah replied, 1 heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, Jjj lfrl»- JjaZ V J^J Jj Jjls ja “Whoever has camels and does not give their due (Zakdh) in their Najdah and their Risl ...a We interrupted saying, ‘O Messenger of Allah! What is their Najdah and Risl?’ He said, 1* life oQJI la la^f OJtf lal^f li^5 i l\$U>-L 'jU-i l\$J ^U'l Ijlj .4L-- IfJajL jJ- df JjliL j\J J> u ills udi Ja 1\$ ijiJbJ % Z dis IM At-Tabari 23 :603

158 Tafsir Ibn Kathir l^Uaj oli i yy £lL L^J ^Lj tOjJip Al^J- o^iSlj C«il5 UlJ>*\ aJjI>- t^j t fr [..sit- Vj »LJajp l\$-J i l^j 0^# Cili J5 AjxiaAJj ^-Ul ^-U2j5j A"— *ta-*^t ^yyw»>- OjIjLt* (1)15* * L* aJLp W»Jup 1 fji^W CJ? C5^ - N aJ CJIS lip .aL^ ^33 oli ojlali ^3^3 ^JuL I4J Lj> 0 L* JIP IS^ ollil I lit l\ ,rtc- Sij frL.^4p L^J 1 l^J^L jy oli pS" A>rla;~j L^iilL will? taL^ waJ(^TM*>- ajtjUA J 15 ^ k IaVjI aIIP OJLpI LaI^>-I AJjb*- ^ ^EJl Je. Ir**- nit is their difficulty and their ease, for verily, they will come on the Day of Resurrection healthier than before. They will be more in number, fatter and more lively and unruly. Then a soft, level plain will be spread out for them and they will trample him with their hooves. When the last of them has passed over him, the first of them will rehim to trample him again during a day whose measure ivill be fifty tlwusand years. Tins will continue until the case of all the people is decided between them. Then he (the withholder of Zakah) will see his path (i.e., either to

Paradise or Hell). If he had cows that he did not pay the Zakah in their ease and their difficult times, then they will come on the Day of Judgement healthier than they were before. They will be more in number, fatter and more lively and unndy. Then a soft, level plain will be spread outfor them and they will trample him. Every one of them that has cloven hooves will trample him with its hooves, and every one of them that has a hom will butt him with its horn . There will not be any hornless or bent homed animals among them . When the last of them has passed over him, the first of them will return to trample him again during a day whose measure will be fifty thousand years. This will continue until the case of all the people is decided between them. Then he (the withholder of Zakah) will see his path (i.e., either to Paradise or Hell). If he has any sheep that he does not pay the due Zakah in their difficulty and their ease, then they will come on the Day of Judgement healthier than they were before. They will be more (in number) fatter and more lively and unruly. Then a soft,

level plain will be spread out for them and they will trample him . Every one of them that has a cloven hoof will trample him with its hooves, and every one of them that has a horn will butt him with its horn. There will not be any hornless or bent homed animals among them . When the last of them has passed over him, the first of them will return to trample him again during a day whose measure will be fifty thousand years. This will continue until the case of all the people is decided between them. Then he (the withholder of Zakdh) will see his path (i.e., either to Paradise or Hell). Then, the man from Bani ‘Amir said, “What is the due of the camel, O Abu Hurayrah?” Abu Hurayrah said, It is that you give (in your Zakdh payment) from your most valuable camels, that you lend a milking she-camel, that you lend your mount for riding, that you give the milk (to the people) for drinking, and you lend the male camel for breeding.”¹¹¹ This Hadith was also recorded by Abu Dawud and An-Nasal.*² A Different Version ofthis Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ojliL jIS ^ -dll iJjS »JOI , ji ur. I . ji ui SLi ‘J ci ,jJc iL sLi JR vThere is not any owner of treasure wlv does not pay its due except that it will be made into heated metal plates and branded upon him in the fire of Hell. Hisforehead, side and back will be scorched with these metal plates. This will continue until Allah judges between His servants on a Day whose measure is fifty thousand years of what you count. Then he will see his path, either to Paradise or to the Fire. Then he (Abu Hurayrah) mentions the rest of the Hadith about the sheep and camels just as mentioned before. In this narration (of Ahmad) the Prophet jg also added, *! Ahmad 2 :489. * Abu Dawud 2 :304, and similar with An-Nasal 12 :5.

"jjJ «The horse isfor three (on the Day ofJudgement) : for one man it is a reward, for another man it is a shield (protection), and upon another man it is a burden .» And the HadSth continues. * Muslim also recorded this Hadith in its entirety even though Al-Bukhari did not mention it. The intent behind mentioning this here is the Prophet’s statement, «Until Allah judges between His servants on a day whose measurement isfifty thousand years. Instructing the Propheti to have Patience Then Allah says, {So be patient, with a good patience meaning, Tie patient, O Muhammad, with your people’s rejection and their seeking to hasten the torment since they think it will not occur.’ Allah says in another Ayah, Cp* ft Jjii.it Lift ofjtj V C/jfi ft {Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth. (42:18) Thus, Allah says, Aw 4Verily, they see it (the torment) afar off meaning, the happening of the torment and the establishment of the Hour (Day of Judgement). The disbelievers see this as something that is farfetched. The word “Ba’id” here means that which is impos- sible to occur. 111 Ahmad 2:262. Muslim 2:682.

iBut We see it (quite) near.} meaning, the believers believe that its occurrence is near, even though its time of occurrence is unknown and no one knows when it will be except Allah. All of

what is approaching then it is near and it will definitely

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happen. Pf 24% oP0 oj j? y 48. T7ie Day that the sky will be like the Al-Muhl.} 49. And the mountains will be like 'Ihn.} 410. And nofriend will ask a friend,} ill. Though they shall be made to see one another, the criminal would desire to ransom himself from the punishment of that Day by his children.} 412. And his wife and his brother,} 413. And his Fasilah who sheltered him,} il4. And all that are in the earth, so that it might save him.} 425. By no means! Verily, it will be the fire of Hell,} il6. Nazzd'ah the Shawa!} 427. Calling (all) such as turn their backs and turn away their faces.} 428. And collect (wealth) and hide it (from spending it in the cause of Allah).} Terrors of the Day of Judgement Allah says that the torment will befall the disbelievers. *P0 4The Day that the sky will be like the Al-Muhl.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ata, Said bin Jubayr, 'Ikrimah, As- Suddi and others have all said, "Like the residue of oil." Jcu Ipf} iAnd the mountains will be like 'Ihn.}

Vj j— <- '1—j' <j iThen, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among than that Day, nor will they ask of one another.} (23:101) and similarly He says, jU julj> j£J 4f***i* 'd> 4l-*i Jt vi' i&aS. {That day shall a man flee from his brother, and from his mother and his father, and from his wife and his children. Every man that Day will have enough to make him careless of others.} (80:34-37) Then Allah's saying here . »" / > •>;? J"V >%•*& f '•eP 4 4*J ^f/ie criminal would desire to ransom himself from the punishment of the Day by his children, and his wife and his brother, and his Fasilah (kindred) who sheltered him, and all that are in the earth, so that it might save him . By no means!} means, no ransom will be accepted from him even if he brought all of the people of the earth (as ransom), and the greatest wealth that he could find, even if it was enough gold to fill the entire earth. Even the child that he had who was dearer to him than the last beat of his heart in the life of this world, he would wish to use the child as a ransom for himself against the torment of Allah on the Day of Judgement when he sees the horrors. However, even this child would not be accepted from him (as a ransom). Mujahid and As-Suddi both said, idr-pj} } and his Fasilah} "This means his tribe and his kin." Ikrimah said, "This means the subdivision of his tribe that he is from." Ashhab reported from Malik that he said, "His Fasilah is his mother." 1M At-Tabari 23 :606

Allah said. iVerily, it will be the fire of Hell,} Here He is describing the Hell- fire and the severity of its heat. iNazza'ah the Shawa!} Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid both said, "It is the skin of the head." 111 Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Thabit Al- Bunani both said, iNazza'ah the Shawa!} "This means respectable parts of the face." Qatadah said, iNazza'ah the Shawa!} "This means removing his important organs, and the respectable parts of his face, his creation and his limbs."*21 Ad-Dahhak said, "This means it will scrape the flesh and the skin off of the bone until it leaves nothing of it remaining. "I31 Ibn Zayd said, "The Shawa is the marrow of the bones."*4 As for, iNazza'ah} Ibn Zayd said, "It is cutting their bones and transformation of their skins and their form." Concerning Allah's statement, C5> A Is iCalling (all) such as turn their backs and turn away their faces. And collect and hide it.} meaning, the Fire will call out to its children whom Allah created for it, determining that they will perform the deeds deserving of it in

the worldly life. So it will call them on the m At-Tabari 23:608. AMabari 23:609. At-Tabari 23:609. [4 ' At-Tabari 23:609.

Day of Judgement with an eloquent and articulate tongue. Then it will pick them out from the people of the gathering just as birds pick seeds. This is because they were, as Allah said, of those who turned their backs and turned away. This means they denied with their hearts and abandoned the performance of deeds with their limbs. iAnd collect and hide it.} meaning, he gathered wealth piling it up, and he concealed it, meaning he hid it and refused to give the obligatory right of Allah that was due on it of spending and paying the Zak&h. It has been recorded in a Hadttth that the Prophet jgg said, •Do not hold back (your wealth) or else Allah toill hold back from yoM.i* 11 jr -•if. ^ JjUJ! s z^z*z y ^ Zz A z ^a* , z t \$i5£ ^ ^^ 'H #• oCijff dl0} \$A ^}P >^ q <*& \$?> i\$ \$\$ {£\$ v'j* Jjpdjiii' (>ty >ybe ji ^ ifi'j ZJ? '•y^u J* J^4 U jl jj* ^1 jje 111 Muslim 2:713.

166 Tahir Ibn Kathir 419. Verily, man was created very impatient;} 420. Apprehensive when evil touches him;} 421. And suppressive when good touches him.} 422. Except those who are devoted to Salah .} 423. Those who with their Salah are Da'imiin;} 424. And those in whose wealth there is a recognized right.} 425. For the one who asks, andfor the deprived.} 426. And those who believe in the Day ofRecompense.} 427. And those whofear the torment of their Lord.} 428. Verily, the torment of their Lord is that before which none can feel secure.} 429. And those who guard their private part (cluistity).} 430. Exceptfrom their wives or their right hand possessions - for (then) they are not blameworthy.} 431 . But whosoever seeks beyond that, then it is those who are trespassers.} 432. And those who keep their trusts and covenants.} 433. And those who standfirm in their testimonies.} 434. And those wlv are with their Salah, Yulwfiziin .} 435. Such shall dwell in the Gardens, twnores} Man is Impatient Allah informs about man and his inclination to corrupt his behavior. Allah says, 4Verily, than was created very impatient;} Then, Allah explains this statement by saying, 4Apprehensive when evil touches him;} meaning, whenever any harm touches him he is frightful, worried and completely taken back due to the severity of his terror and his despair that he

will receive any good after it. Si: 4And suppressive when good touches him.} meaning, if he attains any blessing from Allah, he is stingy with it, not sharing it with others. He will withhold the right of Allah with that blessing. Imam Ahmad said that Abu 'Abdur-Rahman informed them that Musa bin 'Ali bin Rabah told them that he heard his father narrating from 'Abdul-'Aziz bin Marwan bin Al-Hakim that he heard Abu Hurayrah saying, "The Messenger of Allah Sg said, nThe worst thing that can be in a man is greedy impatience and unrestrained cowardice.»11 ' Abu Dawud recorded this Hadith from 'Abdullah bin Al-Jarrah on the authority of Abu 'Abdur-Rahman Al-Muqri', and this is the only Hadith through 'Abdul-'Aziz with him .'21 The Exclusion of Those Who pray from what has preceded and an Explanation of Their Deeds and Their Prayer Then Allah says, 4Except those who are devoted to Salah.} meaning, man is described with blameworthy characteristics except for He whom Allah protects, helps and guides to good, making its means easy for him - and these are those people who perform Salah. tk j iThose wlv with their Salah are Dd'imun;} It has been said that this means they guard its times and the elements obligatory in it. This has been said by Ibn 111 Ahmad 2:302. I2 ' Abu Dawud 3 :26

168 Tafsir Ibtidai Kathir Mas'ud, Mas'ud and Ibrahim An-Nakha'. 111 It has also been said that it means tranquility and humble concentration (in the prayer). This is similar to Allah's statement, (•£\$»» <4 (** J»^ 4, Successful indeed are the believers. Those who with their Salah are Khashi'un> (23:1-2) This was said by Tjibah bin 'Amir. From its meanings is the same terminology used to describe standing (still) water (Al-Ma Ad-Da'im). This proves the obligation of having tranquility in the prayer. For verily, the one who does not have tranquility (stillness of posture) in his bowing and prostrating, then he is not being constant (Da'im) in his prayer. This is because he is not being still in it and he does not remain (in its positions), rather he pecks in it (quickly) like the pecking of the crow. Therefore, he is not successful in performing his prayer. It has also been said that the meaning here refers to those who perform a deed and are constant in its performance and consistent in it. This is like the Hadith that has been recorded in the Sahih on the authority of 'A'ishah that the Messenger of Allah s|| said, "3^ L)\j JLLcVl aThe most beloved deeds to Allah are those that are most consistent, even if they are few . s*2 Then Allah says. 4And those in whose wealth there is a recognized right. For the one who asks, and for the deprived.} meaning, in their wealth is a determined portion for those who are in need. Concerning Allah's statement, 4And those who believe in the Day of Recompense.} meaning, they are sure of the Final Return (to Allah), the At-Jabari 23:612. Muslim 1 :541.

Reckoning and the Recompense. Therefore, they perform the deeds of one who hopes for the reward and fears the punishment. For this reason Allah says, 4And those who fear the torment of their Lord.} meaning, they are fearful and dreadful. j* fry v'j* 4 4Verily, the torment of their Lord is that before which none can feel secure.} meaning, no one is safe from it (Allah's torment) of those who understand the command from Allah, except by the security of Allah Himself. Then Allah says, 4And those who guard their private part (chastity).} meaning, they keep their private parts away from that which is forbidden and they prevent their private parts from being put into other than what Allah has allowed them to be in. This is why Allah says, if 4Except from their wives or their right hand possessions} meaning, from their female slaves. 4for (then) they are not blameworthy. But whosoever seeks beyond that, then it is those who are trespassers.}

The explanation of this has already preceded at the beginning

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of Surat Al-Mu'minun, and therefore does not need to be repeated here. Allah said, 4^of6 p&Ai f c/\$} 4And those who keep their trusts and covenants.} meaning, if they are given a trust they do not deceive and when See the volume six, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Mu'minun (23 :6-7)

they make a covenant they do not break it. These are the characteristics of the believers which are opposite of the characteristics of the hypocrites. This is like what is reported in the authentic Hadith, "The signs of the hypocrites are three. When he speaks he lies, when he promises he breaks his promise, and when he is given a trust he behaves treacherously (with ifj In another narration it states. "j&i lilj ijle- jS\ s- tilj i Jj'jtS lit "When he speaks he lies, when he makes a covenant he breaks it, and when he argues he is abusive Concerning Allah's statement, 4And those who stand firm in their testimonies.} This means that they guard their testimonies. They do not add or decrease from what they testify to nor do they conceal their testimonies. Allah says in another Ayah, ikS iWho hides it, surely, his heart is

sinful.} (2:283) Then Allah says, iAnd those who are with their Salah, Yuhafizun.} meaning, they maintain its proper times, its pillars, its obligations and its recommended acts. So Allah begins this discussion (of the believers' attributes) with prayer and He concludes it with prayer. This proves the importance of it and the praise of its noble status, just as what preceded at the beginning of Surat Al-Mu'minun. It is exactly the same discussion. This is why Allah says there (in Al-Mu'minun), 111 Fath Al-Bari 1:111. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1:111.

iThese are indeed the inheritors. Who shall inherit the Firdaws (Paradise). They shall dwell therein forever.} (23:10-11) And He says here, iSuch shall dwell in the Gardens, honored.} meaning, they will be honored with various types of pleasures and delights. J ft# £4 «*h IS 4> \$3 !£ &S5 «» |4*V >j>' **y*- y-“ <S rr* Wrs 's'W «jtf fJi V^>aJ6Ji “ . C)j-fcy fy)' «!> 436. So, what is the matter with those disbelievers, before you Muhti'Tn} 437. On the right and on the left, 'bin.} 438. Does even/ man of them hope to enter the Paradise of Delight?} < 439. But no! Verily, We have created them out of that which they know!} 440. But no! I swear by the Lord of the easts and the wests that surely We are Able} 443 . To replace than by (others) better than them ; and We are not to be outrun.} 442. So, leave them to plunge in vain talk and play about, until they meet their Day which they are promised.} 443 . The Day when they will come out of the graves quickly as racing to a Nusub,} 444. With their eyes lowered in fear and humility, ignominy covering them (all over)! That is the Day which they were promised!}

The Rebuke of the Disbelievers and the Threat against Them Allah rebukes the disbelievers who, in the time of the Prophet saw him and the guidance Allah sent him with. They witnessed the magnificent miracles Allah aided him with. Then, after all of this they fled from him and separated themselves from him. They fled right and left, group by group and party by party. This is as Allah says, os& % pe iThen what is wrong with them that they run away from admonition? As if they were (frightened) wild donkeys. Fleeing from a beast ofprey.> (74:49-51) This is the example of disbeliever. And this Ayah is similar. As Allah says, iSo what is the matter with those disbelievers, before you Muhti'ln meaning, “what is wrong with these disbelievers who are with you, O Muhammad? Why are they Muhti'ln, meaning hastily running away from you?’ This is as Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, Muhti'ln means departing.” 4fee & iOn the right and on the left, 'Izln.} The singular of 'Izin is 'Izah, which means separating. meaning in their separating and their differing. Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas about the Ayah; iSo what is the matter with those disbelievers, before you Muhti'ln.} “They are looking in your direction.” Then the Ayah, ^@&ie iOn the right and on the left, 'Izlnfr At-Tabari 23 :620.

he (Ibn 'Abbas) said, “Al-'l2m is a group among the people. On the right and on the left means they are turning away (right and left) from him (the Prophet 5g) and mocking him.” Jabir bin Samurah narrated that the Messenger of Allah came out to them while they were sitting in circles. So the Messenger of Allah said, “Why do I see you all 'Izin (in groups).^ Ahmad, Muslim, Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Ibn Jarir all recorded this Hadith.^ Then, concerning Allah's statement. i'yt? 4*1 J*-- '. J j*ri iDoes every man of them hope to enter the Paradise of Delight? But no!} meaning, is this their wish, yet they flee from the Messenger jg in aversion to the truth? Are they hoping that they will be admitted into the Gardens of Delight? Nay, rather their abode is Hell. Then Allah affirms the occurrence of the Final Abode and the torment that will befall them that they are denying its existence and claiming it to be something farfetched. As a proof against them, Allah mentions the initiation of creation, and that

repeating the process is something easier than performing it the first time. This is something that they themselves confess to. Allah says, 4Verily, We have created them out of that which they blow!} meaning, from despised semen. This is as Allah says, iDid We not create you from a despised water (semen)?} (77:20) Allah also says, At-Tabari 23:620. ,2) Ahmad 5:93, Muslim 1:322, Abu Dawud 1:561, An-Nas&l 3:4, and At-Tabari 23 :620

-tft \$ %[ja U eft- ft ££& ft i-^*' %\$* ? <J Cp#2< £ (5^SS 4So fef man see from what he is created! He is created from a water gushing forth. Proceedingfrom between the backbone and the ribs . Verily He is able to bring him back! The Day when all the secrets will be examined. Then he will have no power, nor any helper.} (86:5-10) Then Allah says, jr-1' ft fti ~-%} }But no! I swear by the Lord of the easts and the wests} meaning, the One Who created the heavens and the earth and made the east and the west. He is the One Who subjected the stars causing them to appear in the eastern parts of the sky and vanish in the western parts of it. The point of this statement is that the matter is not as the disbelievers claim: that there is no final return, no reckoning, no resurrection and no gathering. Rather all of this will occur and come to pass. There is no way of avoiding it. This is the reason that Allah has stated a negation at the beginning of this oath. This shows that He is swearing by a denial of their claim. This is a refutation of their false claim of rejecting the Day of Judgement. They already witnessed the greatness of Allah's power in what is more convincing than the Day of Judgement, that is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the subjection of the creatures in them, the animals, the inanimate objects and the other types of creatures that exist. This is why Allah says, V cftftj eft- ft 03 Zi\ eftS} iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind; yet, most of mankind know not.} (40:57) Allah also says, ftf~ ijl ft e>vft~ <ji ft ft ol L?y jbf} i'ft\$ ft

4Do they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is Able to do all things.} (46:33) Allah says in another Ayah, j&i* dr. o' & \$ /j JOg li> #1 U[4/s no/ Ho WJio created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is tire All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!"- and it is!} (36:81,82) So here He says, jjo j& & y>i'j iBut no! I swear by the Lord of tire easts and the wests that surely We are Able -to replace them by (others) better than them..} meaning, 'on the Day of Judgement We will bring them back (to life) in bodies that are better than these bodies that they have now.' For verily, Allah's power is suitable (able) to do that. iand We are not to be outrun.} meaning, *We are not unable.' This is as Allah says, J ifeU& it tffi 4Does man think that We shall not assemble his bones? Yes, We are able to put together in perfect order the tips of his fingers.} (75:3,4) Allah also says, V t* J JjJ J J*- oj-j' \$^i. j*} 4We have decreed death to you all, and We are not outstripped. To transfigure you and create you in (forms) that you brow not.} (56:60,61) Ibn Jarir preferred the meaning to be: 'a nation who will obey

Nun and Sad. This (Nusub) means an idol. With this recitation the Ayah means, as if their rushing to this place was like when they used to hurry in the worldly life to the idol when they saw it. They would rush hurriedly to see who would be the first of them to touch it. This has been reported from Mujahid, Yahya bin Abi Kathir, Muslim Al-Batln, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak, Ar-Rabl' bin Anas, Abu Salih, 'Asim bin Bahdalah, Ibn Zayd and others. Concerning Allah's statement, iWith their eyes lowered in fear> meaning humbled. ^covering them with humility.} meaning, in return for how they behaved arrogantly

in the worldly life by refusing to be obedient (to Allah). if 4' 4# iThat is the Day which they were promised!}

Surah 71: Nuh

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Opening

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Opening The Tafsir of Surah Nuh (Chapter - 71)

Which was revealed in Makkah

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ov • ^ ..fo* -* .a- < A . A AA I'Aif" .- aA"~".«Ja>«- a-* a >U»- Jj£L>jf>^£Aj>teJ<Iy-iC)J
aaaja.^?.if-'. 'a.h'i. A*'.'. ffiSl -oLjl yjitJsA*ji l.UyLLLujiili[j£Sticj)£ sjlj»)is i^p *>•(" . " \ ***:'" 't Si'-
- liCtj In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. J z4^y l*-jj LJl—<3^ tj^ > 4 J ^1*
<il*y ^0 ijl _£jjj JS -j. tfljc it ijlit ot *i o; *j^j ^ dl £££ ji >i| V :t lit it j3 ol 40522 ^r 43 . Verily, We sent
Nm3i to his people (say- ing) : “Warn your people before there comes to them a painful torment.”} 42.
He said: "O my people! Verily, I am a plain wamer to you,"} 43. "That you should worship Allah, and
have Taqwa of Him, and obey me,"} 44. "He will forgive you of your sins and respite you to an
appointed term. Verily, the term of Allah when it comes, cannot be delayed, if you but know."

Nuh's Invitation to His People Allah says concerning Nuh that He sent him to his people commanding him to warn them of the punishment of Allah before it befell them. He was to tell them that if they would repent and turn to Allah, then the punishment would be lifted from them. Due to this Allah says, w. 4 "Warn your people before there comes to them a painful torment." He said : “O my people! Verily, I am a plain wamer to you.”} meaning, clarity of the warning, making the matter apparent and clear. 4»j2l3'j ill iThat you should worship Allah, and have Taqwd of Him,} meaning, ‘abandon those things that He has forbidden and avoid that which He has declared to be sinful.’ 4and obey me,} In that which I command you to do and that which I forbid you from.’ 4He will forgive you of your sins} meaning, ‘if you do what I command you to do and you believe in what I have been sent with to you, then Allah will forgive you for your sins.’ J^&^ iand respite you to an appointed term.} meaning, “He will extend your life span and protect you from the torment that He would have made befall you if you did not stay away from His prohibitions.’ This Ayah is used as proof by those who say that obedience (to Allah), righteousness and maintaining the family ties truly increase the life span of a person. This is like that which has been reported in the Hadith, Ji Xj -f

«Maintaining the family ties increases the life span.® Concerning Allah's statement, % j3 l[} iVerily, the term of Allah when it comes, cannot be delayed, if you but know means, hasten to the obedience (of Allah) before the coming of His vengeance. For verily, if He commands that to happen, it cannot be repulsed or prevented. For He is the Great One Who compels everything, and He is the Almighty

Whose might all of creation succumbs to. m /*> » * t S • -/> > . * f* Jt" / ' *•' I >y/ « ./ <^V jt 52 '££3; -j j# *4; fS ^33 pS itp&i -& 45. He said: O my Lord! Verily, I have called to my people night and day,} 46. But all my calling added nothing but to (their) flight.} 47. And verily, every time I called unto them that You might forgive them, they thrust their fingers into their ears, covered themselves up with their garments, and persisted, and magnified themselves in pride.} 48. Then verily, I called to them openly (aloud).} 49. Then verily, I proclaimed to them in public, and I have appealed to them in private.} 410. I said (to them): Ask forgiveness from your Lord, verily. He is Oft-Forgiving;} ill. He will send rain to you Midrar,} I 1 * Ibn Shihab 1 :93. See As-\$ahihah no. 1908.

il2. And give you increase in wealth and children, and bestow on you gardens and bestow on you rivers.} 413. What is the matter with you, that you do not hopefor any Waqarfrom Allah?} 414. While He has created you (in) Atwar (stages).} 415. See you not how AllSh has created the seven heavens in tiers?} 416. And has made the moon a light therein, and made the sun a lamp?} 417. And Allah has brought you forth from the (dust of) earth?} 418. Afterwards He will return you into it (the earth), and bring youforth.} 419. And Allah has madefor you the earth a wide expanse.} 420. That you may go about therein in broad roads.} Nuh complains about his Encounter with His People Allah tells about His servant and Messenger, Nuh, and that he complained to his Lord about the response he received from his people, and how he was patient with them for this long period of time - which was nine hundred and fifty years. He complained due to his explaining and clarifying matters for them and his calling them to guidance and the straightest path. So he (Nuh) said, 4fXri utj ^3} 40 my Lord! Verily, I have called to my people night and day,} meaning, 1 did not abandon calling them night and Hay carrying out Your command and in obedience to You.' 4But all my calling added nothing but to (their) flight.} meaning, "the more I called them to come to the truth, the more they fled from it and avoided it.' —•j '\$«* J+l jtJci jLpyo LJ£=» ^ji}

effective with them. What Nuh saidwhen He called His People to Allah •• *.l . Ill 41 said: Ask forgiveness from your Lord, verily, He is Oft- Forgiving;) meaning, 'return to Him and turn away from what you are involved in. Repent to Him soon, for verily. He is Most Accepting of the repentance of those who turn to Him in repentance. He will accept repentance no matter what the sin is, even if it is disbelief and polytheism.' Thus, he said, iLlli J-jj^bU* /Sj 'fS3j lii 41 said: Ask forgiveness from your Lord, verily, He is Oft- Forgiving; He will send rain to you Midrar, meaning, continuous rain. Thus, it is recommended to recite this Surah in the prayer for rain due to this Ayah. This has been reported from the Commander of the faithful, Umar bin Al-Khattab. He ascended the Minbar to perform the prayer for rain, and he did not do more than seeking Allah's forgiveness and reciting the Ayat that mention seeking Allah's forgiveness. Among these Ayat. 4 i>l? /&) 'f&j 41 said: Ask forgiveness from your Lord, verily, He is Oft- Forgiving; He will send rain to you Midrar,) Then he (Umar) said, "Verily, I have sought rain with the keys of the sky which cause the rain to descend." Ibn 'Abbas and others have said, "It [Midrar) means some of it (rain) following others." Concerning Allah's statement, 4l<k& 4And give you increase in wealth and children, and bestow on you gardens and bestow on you rivers.) meaning, 'ifyou repent to Allah, seek His forgiveness and obey Him, He will increase your provisions for you and provide you with water from the blessings of the sky. He will cause the

Allah has created the seven heavens in tiers and has made the moon a light therein, and made the sun a lamp?} meaning, He made a distinction between them (the sun and moon) in reference to their lighting. He made each one of them in a set manner with a distinct quality so that the night and day may be known. They (the night and day) are known by the rising and setting of the sun. He also determined fixed stations and positions for the moon, and He made its light vary so that sometimes it increases until it reaches a maximum, then it begins to decrease until it is completely veiled. This shows the passing of months and years. This is as Allah said, it is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a light and measured out for its stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning. Allah did not create this but in truth. He explains the Ayat in detail for people who have knowledge.} (10:5) Concerning Allah's statement, 'And Allah has brought you forth from the (dust of) earth?' This (Nabat) is a verbal noun (for emphasis) and its usage here is most excellent. 'And afterwards He will return you into it (the earth),' (71:18) meaning, when you die. 'And bring you forth.'} meaning, on the Day of Judgement He will repeat your creation just as He first originated you. 'And Allah has made for you the earth a wide expanse.'} meaning, He spread it out, leveled it, settled it, and stabilized it with firm and lofty mountains.

'That you may go about therein in broad roads.'} meaning, He created it so that you may settle in it and travel in it wherever you wish, from its different sides, areas and regions. All of this is from what Nuh informed them of concerning Allah's power and His greatness in creating the heavens and the earth. It demonstrates the favor that He did for them by making both heavenly benefits and earthly benefits. For He is the Creator and the Sustainer Who made the heaven as a building and the earth as a bed, and He enlarged His provisions for His creatures. Therefore, He is the One Who it is obligatory to worship, and accept as One God. No one should be associated with Him as a partner, because He has no equal, peer, rival, coequal, mate, son, minister or advisor, rather He is the Most High, the Most Great. 'And they have plotted a mighty plot.'} 413. 'And they have said: 'You shall not leave your gods, nor shall you leave Wadd, nor Suwa, nor Yaghuth, and Ya'uiq and Nasr.' '}' 414. 'And indeed they have led many astray. And (O Allah): 'Grant no increase to the wrongdoers save error.' '4 Nuh complains to His Lord about His People's Response Allah says that Nuh turned to Allah to inform Allah - the All Knowing from Whom nothing escapes - that he presented the clear call, as mentioned previously, and the comprehensive invitation in various ways. He called them sometimes by encouragement and sometimes by intimidating warnings. Yet, they disobeyed him, opposed him, denied him and followed the children of the world. They were those who were heedless of

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the command of Allah and they possessed delights of wealth

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6133]

and children. However, these things (worldly benefits) were also for gradual punishment and temporary respite, not for honor or blessing. Thus, Allah says, 'And followed one whose wealth and children give him no increase but loss.'

The meaning of Allah's statement,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6133–6138]

4^b'^=> \jZj} 4And they have plotted a mighty plot.} is that they plotted a deceptive plot for their followers tricking them into believing that they were following the truth and correct guidance. This is like what they will say to them on the Day ofJudgement, ji] JaIsj Jit j&i o' i) jjt 4Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day : when you orderd us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!} (34:33) For this reason He says here,

The Idols of the People ofNuh and what happened to Him ££ % & % &): y ijig@ 1 i iAnd they have plotted a mighty plot. And they have said: 'You shall not leave your gods, nor shall you leave Wadd, nor Suwd', nor Yaghuth, and Ya'iiq and Nasr.}' These are the names of their idols which they used to worship besides Allah. Al-Bukh&ri recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "The idols that were among the people of NQh wound up among the Arabs afterwards. In reference to Wadd, it became the idol of the people of Kalb in the area of Dawmat Al-Jandal. Suwa' became the idol of the people of Hudhayl. Yaghuth became the idol of the people of Murad, then the people of Bani Ghutayf at Al-Juruf in the area of Saba' worshipped it after them. Ya'uq became the idol of the people of Hamdan. Nasr became the idol of the people of Himyar for the family of Dhu Kala'. These idols were all named after righteous men from the people of NQh. Then when these men died, Shaytan inspired his (NQh's) people to erect statues in honor of them at their gathering places where they used to come and sit, and to name these statues after these men (with their names). So they did this (as Shaytan suggested), but these statues were not worshipped until after those people (the ones who built them) had died and the knowledge was lost. Then, those statues were later worshipped." This has also been similarly reported from 'Ikrimah, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah and Ibn Ishaq. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "These are statues that were worshipped in the time of NQh."*2 * Ibn Jarir recorded from Muhammad bin Qays that he said concerning YaghQth, Ya*Qq and Nasr, "They were righteous people between the time of Adam and NQh, and they had followers who used to adhere to their guidance. Then, when they died, their companions who Path Al-Bari 8 :535 * At-Jabari 23:640.

used to follow them said, "If we make images of them, it will increase our desire to perform worship when we remember them.' So they made images of them. Then, when those people died and other people came after them, Iblis approached them and said, They (your predecessors) used to worship these statues and they were granted rain by their worship of them.' Thus, they (the latter people) worshipped them." The Supplication of Nuh against His People and for whoever believed inHim Allah then says, 4U 4And indeed they have led many astray meaning, by the idols that they took for worship, they mislead a large number of people. For verily, the worship ofthose idols continued through- out many generations until our times today, among the Arabs, the non-Arabs and all the groups of the Children of Adam. Al- KhalU (Prophet Ibrahim) said in his supplication, s; <*r o&a Vk ojt&LM o' 4And keep me and my sons away from worshipping idols."O my Lord! They have indeed led astray many among mankind..." (14:35,36) Allah then says, 4;\$&uk Sji^ jj%} 4Grant no increase to the wrongdoers save error.} This is a supplication from him (NOh) against his people due to their rebellion, disbelief and obstinacy. This is just as Musa supplicated against Fir'awn and his chiefs in his statement. 4 !a£ &- iAsji j-vjb & Tsldj J-djA JJA £j} 4Our Lord ! Destroy their wealth, and harden their hearts, so

that they will not believe until they see the painful torment.) (10 :88) Verily, Allah responded to the supplication of both of these Prophets concerning their people and He drowned their nations due to their rejection of what he (that Prophet) had

come with. V Zp fy -if o ^ p 'j^ U>^ ^-i4 r^li ijit -Jj ijLju ol, j'^3' S; jc jji jji 'ij U-\$l f- J-io ,>h cMyb J J-j*f 44 4@\$6 'il cgJ^> ^25. Because o/ their sins they were drowned, then were made to enter the Fire. And they found none to help them instead of Allah. 426. And Nuh said: "My Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers on the earth Dayyar!" } \$27. "If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants, and they will beget none but wicked disbelievers." } 428. "My Lord! Forgive me, and my parents, and him who enters my home as a believer, and all the believing men and women. And to the wrongdoers grant You no increase but destruction!" } Allah says, irf&Lt:} 4Because of their sins} It also has been recited as; (their errors.) 4they were drowned,} meaning, for their numerous sins, rebellion, persistence in disbelief and opposition to their Mes- sengers. 4# *4^ ithey were drowned, then were made to enter the Fire.} meaning, they will be carried from the flood of the seas to the heat of the Fire. -if j}J it p* \$*} 4And theyfound none to help them instead ofAllah.}

meaning, they will have no helper, assistant, or savior who can rescue them from the punishment of Allah. This is similar to Allah's statement, YJ& Lri iThis day there is no saviorfrom the decree ofAllah except him on whom He has mercy. (1 1:43) 05^3? * Jis £ fi f 4And Nuh said: "My Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers on the earth Dayyar!" } meaning, do not leave a single one of them on the face of the earth, not even a lone individual. This is a method of speaking that gives emphasis to the negation. Ad-Dahhak said, "Dayyar means one." As-Suddi said, "Dayyar is the one who stays in the home." So Allah answered his supplication and He destroyed all of those on the face of the earth who were disbelievers. He (Allah) even destroyed Nuh's (biological) son from his own loins, who separated himself from his father (Nuh). He (Nuh's son) said, i'-j J4 Y) Ort Y u ipt \%z 41 will betake myself to some mountain, it will save me from the ivater. Nuh said: "This day there is no savior from the decree of Allah except him on whom He has mercy." And waves came in between them, so he (the son) xvas among the drowned.} (11:43) Allah saved the people of the ship who believed with Nuh, and they were thosewhom Allah commanded Nuh to carry with him. Allah said, 4If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants,} meaning, 'if You leave a single one of them they will lead your servants astray.' This refers to those whom He will create after them. 41§-<M=> Yl &£

iarid they will beget none but wicked disbelievers meaning, wicked in their deeds and disbelieving in their hearts. He {Nuh} said this due to what he knew about them since he remained among them for nine hundred and fifty years. Then he said, 4My Lord! Forgive me, and my parents, and him who alters my home as a believer,> » Ad-Dahhak said, "This means, my Masjid." However, there is no harm in understanding the Ayah according to its apparent i meaning, which would be that he (Nuh) supplicated for every personwho entered his househowas a believer.Then he said, iand all the believing men and women. He supplicated for all of the believing men and women, and that includes those of them who were living and those of them who were dead. For this reason, it is recommended to supplicate like this, in following the example of NQh, and that which has been reported in the narrations and well-known, legislated supplications. Then, he said, iAnd to the wrongdoers, grant You no increase but destruction!\$

As-Suddi said, “But destruction.” Mujahid said, “But loss.” This means in both this life and in the Hereafter.

Surah 72: Al-Jinn

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6139]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-Jinn (Chapter - 72)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6139–6162]

na'fes ovt V, In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. * e-' a ai oJ lP- ijlii jjb Ji a %4£ 3, o' '£•" ' ./ y,/ Jj -Xitfl U ^1*) ^ \$; J Hi tlj |JjllaJau* aI>1 ^Jc- pf Si 3Cj s? "*" 'ft ' ' n*' ' ^ « yW.. Si pi cr iji^ 4i.v~ij*5 'lii ip ^ 42. Say: "It has beat revealed to me that a group of Jitm listened. vl-v.Jji 0 ju£i'yX£M'j0<0'/±0 tij0 'iSyftpi!_LSo^" cPSil~J»tij tajj j_jlip JsaAIUjPoll! ^ iSaSVjL They said: 'Verily , we have heard a wonderful Recitation!'} 42. 'It guides to tlte right path, and we have believed therein, and we shall never join anything with our Lord.'} 43. 'And He, exalted be the Jadd ofour Lord, has taken neither

a wife nor a son.'} 44. 'And that the foolish among us used to utter against Allah that which was an enormity in falsehood.'} 45 . 'And verily, we thought that men and Jinn would not utter a lie against Allah.'} 46. And verily, there were men among mankind who took shelter with the males among the Jinn, but they increased them in Rahaq.'} 47. And they tlwught as you thought, that Allah will not send any Messenger.'} The Jinns listening to the Qur'an and Their Beliefin It, Allah commands His Messenger to inform his people that the Jinns listened to the Qur'an, believed in it, affirmed its truthfulness and adhered to it. So Allah says, 4Say: "It has been revealed to me that a group ofJinn listened. They said: 'Verily, we lutve heard a wonderful Recitation! It guides to the right path' " } meaning, to what is correct and success. 4attd we have believed therein, and we shall never join anything with our Lord.} This position (that they took) is similar to what Allah said, 4And when VJe sent towards you a group of the Jinns listening to the Qur'an.} (46:29) We have already presented the Hadiths that have been narrated concerning this, so there is no need to repeat them here.111 Concerning Allah's statement, i%t 111 See volume nine the Tafsir of SuratAl-Ahqaf(46 :29)

195Surah 72. Al-Iinn (1-7) (Part-29 4And He, exalted be the Jadd ofour Lord,} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said concerning Allah's statement, 4the Jadd ofour Lord,} "This means, His actions, His commands and His power. J1 Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Allah's Jadd is His blessings. His power and His favor upon His creation." It has been reported from Mujahid and "IkTimah that they said, "It (Jadd) is the magnificence of our Lord." Qatadah said, "Exalted is His magnificence. His greatness and His command." As-Suddi said, "Exalted is the

command of our Lord.” It has been reported from Abu Ad-Darda’, Mujahid and Ibn Jurayj that they said, “Exalted is His remembrance (Dhikr)” The Jinns Affirmation that Allah does not have a Wife and Children Allah says, 4He has taken neither a wife nor a son.} meaning, far exalted is He above taking a mate and having children. This means that when the Jinns accepted Islam and believed in the Qur’an they professed Allah’s magnificence above having taken a spouse and a child (or a son). Then they said, t 'lli 4iil je Jji if JJj} 4And that the foolish among us used to utter against Allah that which was an enormity in falsehood.} Mujahid, ‘Ikrimah, Qatadah and As-Suddi, all said, 4thefoolish among us} “They were referring to Iblls.” 4&&} 111 At-Jabari 23:648.

196 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ithat which was an enormity in falsehood.} As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik that he said, “This means a transgression.” Ibn Zayd said, “A great injustice.” The foolish (Safih) also carries the meaning of everyone in the category who claims that Allah has a spouse or a son. This is why Allah says here, iAnd that the foolish among us used to utter} meaning, before his acceptance of Islam. 4j)| Jfi} iagainst Allah tlwt which was an enormity in falsehood.} meaning, falsehood and a lie. Thus, Allah says, at&f»»vax&Jis iAnd verily, we thought that men and Jinn would not utter a lie against Allah.} meaning, “we did not think that humans and Jinns would join each other in lying about Allah by attributing a spouse and a son to Him. So when we heard this Qur’an we believed in it and we knew that they (Jinns and men) had been lying about Allah in this matter.’ Among the Causes of the Transgression of the Jinns were thatHumans sought Refuge withThem Allah says. oj^ oj£> O' o? \$j} iAnd verily, there were men among mankind who took shelter with the males among the Jinn, but they increased them in Rahaq.} meaning, Sve used to think that we had some virtuous status over mankind because they used to seek refuge with us whenever they (men) would settle in a valley or any place in the wilderness, the open country steppes and other places.’ This was the custom of the Arabs in the pre-Islamic days of ignorance. They used to seek refuge with the greatest Jinn of a particular place so that no harm or evil would afflict them.

197Surah 72. Al-linn (1-7) (Part-29) Like one would do if he entered into the land of his enemies, in the vicinity of a great and powerful mem, he would seek the protection and guardianship of that man. So when the Jinns saw that the humans were seeking refuge with them due to their fear of them, they increased them in Rahaq which means fear, terror and fright. They did this so that the people would be more afraid of them and seek refuge with them even more. As Qatadah said concerning this Ayah, 'j ibut they increased them in Rahaq.\$ “meaning, in sin, and that the Jinns become more bold and daring against them. Ath-Thawri said from Mansdr, from Ibrahim, concerning the Ayah ibut they increased them in Rahaq.} means, “the Jinns were courageous and increased in insolence against them.” As-Suddi said, “A man used to set out with his family (on a journey) until he came to a piece of land where he would settle. Then he would say, *1 seek refuge with the master {Jinn) of this valley from the Jinns, or that myself, my wealth, my child or my animals are harmed in it.’ ” Qatadah said, “When they sought refuge with them instead of Allah, the Jinns would overcome them with harm because of that.” Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from ‘Ikrimah that he said, “The Jinns used to fear humans just like humans fear them, or even worse. So whenever humans would come to a valley the Jinns would flee. So the leader of the people would say, We seek refuge with the leader of the inhabitants of this valley.’ So the Jinns said, We see these people fleeing from us just like we flee from them.’ Thus, the Jinns started coming near the humans and afflicting them with insanity and madness.” Thus, Allah said, (Ujib*\$ 0 iAnd verily, there

were men among mankind who took shelter with the males among the Jinn, but they increased them in number. At-Tabari 23 :655.

Rahat.} meaning, in sin. Abu 'Aliyah, Ar-Rabi' and Zayd bin Aslam, all said, in Rahat} "This means in fear." Mujahid said, "The disbelievers would increase in transgression." Concerning Allah's statement. lit&Z j J Ct iyi 4And they thought as you thought, that Allah will not send any Messenger.} meaning, Allah would never send a Messenger after this long period of time. This was said by Al-Kalbi and Ibn Jarir. jeZ&ZZgr 6j m Cj jojVf <j JL ijt zijx v Gtj o"S"f gf~i S >'< - 4 <43. 'And we have sought to reach the heaven; but we found it filled with stern guards and flaming fires.'} 49. 'And verily, we used to sit there in stations, to (steal) a hearing, but any who listens now will find a flaming fire watching him in ambush.'} 410. 'And we know not whether evil is intended for those on the earth, or whether their Lord intends for them guidance.'} The Jinns stealing information from the sky before the Messenger was sent and striking them with flaming fire after His coming Allah informs about the Jinns when He sent His Messenger Muhammad and revealed the Qur'an to him. Among the ways He protected it (the Qur'an) was by filling sky with stern guards guarding it from all of its sides. The devils were then expelled from the places where they used to sit prior to that. This was so that they could not steal anything from the Qur'an and tell it to the soothsayers, thereby causing matters to be confused and mixed up. If this happened it would not be

199 Surah 72. Al-I'tim (8-10) (Part-29) known who was being truthful. Allah did this out of His kindness to His creation, His mercy upon His servants and His protection of His Mighty Book (the Qur'an). This is why the Jinns said, J&'&ZZK c# &Z2 Cj i3> 4^62 ife %4 '& iAnd we have sought to reach the heaven ; but found it filled with stern guards and flaming fires. And verily, we used to sit there in stations, to (steal) a hearing, but any who listens now will find a flaming fire watching him in ambush meaning, whoever would like to steal some information by listening, he will find a flaming fire waiting in ambush for him. It will not pass him or miss him, but it will wipe him out and destroy him completely. pFJ (*r j!3* ^ j 44 tsjx V £1)^ iAnd we know not whether evil is intended for those on earth, or whether their Lord intends for them guidance meaning, "we do not know if this - the matter which has occurred in the sky - is intended for those who sire in the earth or if their Lord intends some guidance for them.' They stated this in such a manner out of their etiquette in phrasing their speech, because they did not attribute the doing of evil to anyone and they attributed the good to Allah. Verily, it has been recorded in the Sahih, •Jjdi - "And evil is not attributed to You (Allah) .n' 1 ' It used to be that shooting stars (meteors) occurred before this, however it did not happen much, rather only occasionally. As was reported in the Hadith of Ibn 'Abbas when he said, "While we were sitting with the Messenger of Allah 5&> a shooting star flashed in the sky. So the Prophet% said, «?!JU ofijjb 'pZf '-*8 111 Muslim 1 :535.

*What did you all used to say about this? We replied, "We used to say that a great person has been born and a great person has died." The Prophet and said, nUiJJ >S ^ \i\ 2.1 'JSj .ill& "This is not so, rather whenever Allah decrees a matter in the heaven..." and then he went on to narrate the rest of the Hadith) 1] which we have already mentioned in its entirety in Surah Saba'. 121 This is what caused them to seek the reason for this occurrence. So they set out searching in the east and the west. Then they found the Messenger of Allah reciting (the Qur'an) while leading his Companions in prayer. Thus, they knew that

this Qur'an was the reason for the sky being guarded. Therefore, some among them believed in it and the others became more rebellious in their transgression. A discussion of this has preceded in a Hadith of Ibn 'Abbas concerning Allah's statement in Surat Al-Ahqaf, OjIjLj jjJi £ \Ju iAnd (remetnber) when We sent towards you (Muhammad) a group of the Jinn (quietly) listening to the Qur'an (46:29) There is no doubt that when so many shooting stars began appearing in the sky, it horrified humans and Jinns alike. They were very disturbed and alarmed by it. They thought that it was the destruction of the world. As-Suddi said, "The sky was never guarded except if there was a Prophet in the earth or the religion of Allah was victorious and dominant in the earth." So the devils before the time of Muhammad jg had taken sitting stations for themselves in the heaven of this world and they would listen to the matters that occurred in the heaven. Muslim 4 :1750. 121 See volume eight, the Tafsir of Surah Saba' (34 :22-23). The actual narration was removed from the abridged edition, but the discussion remains , along with a similar narration recorded by Al- Bukhari and others *31 Path Al-B&ri 8 :537 . See the explanation of (46 :29) in volume nine

201Surah 72. Al-Iinn (11-17) (Part-29) But when Allah sent Muhammad jg as a Prophet and Messenger, they were suddenly pelted one night (with the flaming, shooting stars). So the people of Ta'if were frightened because of this and they began to say, 'The dwellers of the sky have been destroyed.' This was because they saw the severe fires in the sky and the shooting flames. They began freeing their servants and abandoning their luxuries. So 'Abd Yalayl bin 'Amr bin TJmayr said to them - and he was referred to for judgement among them - "Woe to you O people of Ta'if! Hold on to your wealth and look at these guiding stars in the sky. If you see them remaining in their place, then the dwellers of the sky have not been destroyed, rather this has happened because of Ibn Abi Kabshah (- meaning Muhammad jg). And if you look and see that you can no longer see these stars, then verily the dwellers of the sky have been destroyed." So, they looked and saw that the stars still remained, and thus, they kept their wealth. The devils also were frightened during that night. They went to Iblls and informed him of what happened to them. So he (Iblls) said, "Bring me a handful of dirt from every land so that I may smell it." So they brought it and he smelled it and said, "It is your friend in Makkah." Then he sent a group of seven Jinns to Makkah, and they found the Prophet of Allah standing in prayer in Al-Masjid Al-Haram while reciting the Qur'an. They drew near to him eager to hear the Qur'an, until their chests almost pressed against him. Then they accepted Islam and Allah revealed their matter to His Messenger sg. We have mentioned this chapter in its entirety in the first section of the Kitab As- Sirah with lengthy discussionS Allah knows best and unto Him is all praise and blessings. y; <h 13,£ &r. axil a ft; ^ J; ft; it itj lii it, ct; @id£ ftit &lL) Jii& ifjt (11 There is a similar narration from Ibn 'Abbas recorded by At-Tabari See volume eight, the Tafsirof Surat As-\$affat (37 :6-10)

111. 'There are among us some that are righteous, and some the contrary; we are groups having different ways.'} 'And we think that we cannot escape Allah in the earth, nor can we escape Him byflight.'} 113. 'And indeed when we heard the Guidance, we believed therein, and whosoever believes in his Lord shall have no fear, either of a decrease in the reward of his good deeds or an increase in the punishmentfor his sins.'} 114. 'And of us some are Muslims, and of us some are Al- Qasitiin. And whosoever has embraced Islam, then such have sought the right path.' " } 115. And asfor the Qasitun, they shall befirewoodfor Hell.} 116. If they had believed in Allah, and went on the way, We would surely have bestowed on them water in abundance.} 417. T/uit We might try them thereby. And

whosoever turns away from the Reminder of his Lord, He will cause him to enter in a Sa'ad torment.} The Jinns testify that among them there are Believers, Disbelievers, Misguided and Guided Allah says that the Jinns said about themselves, Oji lijj £• \$j} iThere are among us some that are righteous, and some the contrary;} meaning, other than that. 4We are groups following different ways.} meaning, on numerous differing paths and having different thoughts and opinions. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others have said, &&} 4We are groups having different ways.} "This means among us are believers and among us are disbelievers."* 11 111 At-Tabari 23:659.

203 Surah 72. Al-Jinn (11-17) (Part-29) Ahmad bin Sulayman An-Najjad reported in his (book of) Amali that he heard Al-A'mash saying, "A Jinn came to us, so I said to him, What is the most beloved food to your kind?" He replied, 'Rice.' So we brought them some rice and I saw the morsels being lifted but I did not see a hand lifting it. So I asked him, 'Do you have these desires (religious innovations) among your kind as we have among ours?' He replied, 'Yes.' Then I said, *Who are the Rafidah ' among you?' He said, They are the worst of us.' " I presented this chain of narration to our Shaykh, Al-Hafiz Abi Al-Hajjaj Al-Mizzi and he said its chain is authentic to Al-A'mash. The Jinns confess to Allah's Perfect Power Concerning Allah's statement, \$And we think that we cannot escape Allah in the earth, nor can we escape Him by flight. meaning, "we know that the power of Allah is decisive over us and that we cannot escape Him in the earth. Even if we try to flee, we know that He has complete control over us and that none of us can escape Him.' • 4, 'it £'• Sjiif CLU. UJ iftj} 4And indeed when we heard the Guidance, we believed therein,} They were proud of this, and it is something for them to be proud of, as well as a great honor for them and a good characteristic. Concerning their statement, Yj IS. iand whosoever believes in his Lord shall have no fear, either of a decrease in the reward of his good deeds or an increase in the punishment for his sins.} Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and others said, "This means, he should not fear that the reward for his good deeds will be decreased or that he will be burdened with anything other than his [i] A group of Shiites

204 Tafslr Ibtî Kathîr sins." ' This is as Allah says, % (K £& iThen he will have no fear of injustice, nor of any curtailment.} (20:112) ilj \L. iAnd of us some are Muslims, and of us some are Al- QasitQn.} meaning, 'among us there is the Muslim and the Qasit' The Qasit is he who behaves unjustly with the truth and deviates from it. This is the opposite of the Muqsit, the one who is just. iAnd whosoever has embraced Islam, then such have sought the right path.} meaning, they sought salvation for themselves. tjfc jLIX i%} iAnd as far as the Qdsitiin, they shall be firewood for Hell.} meaning, fuel, for they will be used to kindle it (the Fire). Concerning Allah's statement. <k £ fg&i iijlf£ %} if they had believed in Allah, and went on the way. We would surely have bestowed on them water in abundance. That We might try them thereby.} The commentators have differed over the explanation of this. There are two views concerning it. The First View That if the deviant ones would stand firmly upon the path of Islam, being just upon it and remaining upon it, i&& i2 fifty£i} iWe would surely have bestowed on them water in abundance.} m Af-Tabari 23 :660.

205 Surah 72. Al-Jinn (11-17) (Part-29) meaning, a lot. The intent behind this is to say that they would be given an abundance of sustenance. With this, the meaning of Allah's statement, iThat We might try them thereby.} is that, *We will test them.' As Malik reported from Zayd bin Aslam, he said, "That We might try them - means, so that We may test them to see who will remain upon the guidance from those

who will turn back to sin.” Mentioning Those Who held this View Al-‘Awfi reported similar to this from Ibn ‘Abbas, and likewise said Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayyib, ‘Ata, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Kalj Al-Qurazi, Qatadah and Ad- Dahhak. Muqatil said, “This Ayah was revealed about the disbelievers of the Quraysh when they were deprived of rain for seven years The Second View if they had believed in Allah, and went on the way,} meaning, of misguidance. \$We would surely have bestowed on them water in abundance.} meaning, Then We would have increased their sustenance to allow a gradual respite.’ As Allah says, Tjijl U ij*- *. L> U-U^ liji <*So, when they forgot that with which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of everything, until in the midst I 1 ' This is a Mursal narration.

£* ljt.fi Vi ji A>,' ,J> ^j) jil iIs ^ti Q JJj jil a^c »jSJ. a 4r^ % 4j j i> ja 4* v 4> jj Oi^ o> ^ X> > ' t .',' »"\\ ;; oj -*T 0*-> -u' jLj /i 4 4^ j?*> J*j ;£*- jJWJUI IJa OyUi- >a4>- *** f ^ > t' ?.?' *>* jjJU—i ojJEj> u Iij bj 418. And the Masjids are for Allah, so invoke not anyone alone with Allah.) 419. And when the servant of Allah stood up invoicing Him in prayer as if sticking one over ovr mmm Sc.jU t-t 411filfcP UQ.4jJ 4jlt£* ip--&m4&-Will! I Jpi^Jjiy^VC^ji j3,4^coJ> jj0 ' <ss 's' K >"s*\\ • " C Vt/ 5 juji^JlUijlJ I 'AjILjjcSA^~ j>> ^ „< *, li i/'^ ^ 'aa_cJslj^t.w«jw>' ly olCs^^O*^1\$ \\>Ac- |*£jJ Cfil. -j they just made round him a dense crowd the other.) 420. Say: "J invoke only my Lord, and I associate none as partners along with Him.”) 421. Say: “It is not in my power to cause you harm, or to bring you to the right path.”) 422. Say: "None can protect me from Allah's punishment, nor can I find refuge except in Him.”) 423. "(Mine is) but conveyance from Allah and His Messages, and whosoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, for him is the fire of Hell, he shall dwell therein forever.”) 424. Till, when they see that which they are promised, then they will know who it is that is weaker concerning helpers and

208 Tafstr Ibn Kathir less important concerning numbers.} The Command to worship Allah Alone and shun Shirk Allah commands His servants to single Him out alone for worship and that none should be supplicated to along with Him, nor should any partners be associated with Him. As Qatadah said concerning Allah’s statement, jit ijpj; i \$f} i And the Masjids are for Allah, so invoke not anyone along with Allah.} “Whenever the Jews and Christians used to enter their churches and synagogues, they would associate partners with Allah. Thus, Allah commanded His Prophet sg to tell them that they should single Him out alone for worship.’^ Ibn Jarir recorded from Said bin Jubayr that he said concerning this verse, \\y-£% i JUiUii '\$j} i And the Masjids are Jbr Allah, so invoke not anyone along with Allah.} “The Jinns said to the Prophet of Allah jg, ‘How can we come to the Masjid while we are distant - meaning very far away - from you? And how can we be present for the prayer while we are far away from you?’ So Allah revealed this Ayah, it\$ff±2 £ tjfcX ft i JwU'l \$j} i And the Masjids are for Allah, so invoke not anyone along with Allah.}’*2' The Jinns crowding together to hear the Qur’an Allah said, it\$&& \\X tfz if£* Q *«' 'to i And when the servant of Allah stood up invoking Him in prayer they just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking At-Tabari 23:665. At-Tabari 23 :665 . This is a Mursal narration

one over the other.} Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “When they heard the Prophet ig reciting the Qur’an they almost mounted on top of him due to their zeal. When they heard him reciting the Qur’an they drew very near to him. He was unaware of them until the messenger (i.e., Jibril) came to him and

made him recite, ii# ih? iSay: "It has been revealed to me that a group of Jinn listened."} (72:1) They were listening to the Qur'an." This is one opinion and it has been reported from Az-Zubayr bin Al-'Awwam. Ibn Jarir recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "The Jinns said to their people, 4'xJ Sift ty-l jiil iS iwhen the servant of Allah stood up invoicing Him in prayer they just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking one over the other.} When they saw him praying and his Companions were bowing with his bowing and prostrating with his prostrating, they were amazed at his Companions obedience to him. Therefore, they said to their people, & \;>t £1 it is fi \i} iwhen the servant of Allah stood up invoking Him in prayer they just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking one over the other.}' This is the second view and it has also been reported from Said bin Jubayr. 12 ' Al-Hasan said, "When the Messenger of Allah jgg stood up and said none has the right to be worshipped except Allah, and he called the people to their Lord, the Arabs almost crowded over him together (against him)."*3 * Qatadah said concerning Allah's statement. At-Tabari 23:667. [2] At-Tabari 23 :667 ^ Af-Tabari 23 : 668 . This is also a Mursal narration

210 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ^ ijil^ >y-Z fil ilt U \$y} izohen the servant of Allah stood up invoking Him in prayer they just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking one over the other. "Humans and Jinns both crowded together over this matter in order to extinguish it. However, Allah insisted upon helping it, supporting it and making it victorious over those who opposed it." * This is the third view and it has also been reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Ibn Zayd. It was also the view preferred by Ibn Jarir.12 ' This view seems to be the most apparent meaning of the Ayah due to Allah's statement which follows it, ^ i^*a j*) iSay : "I invoke only my Lord, and I associate none as partners along with Him."} meaning, when they harmed him, opposed him, denied him and stood against him in order to thwart the truth he came with, and to unite against him, the Messenger jg said to them ijftS ~fy} il invoke only my Lord,} meaning, 1 only worship my Lord alone, and He has no partners. I seek His help and I put my trust in Him.' iC* l< \ %'} iand I associate none as partners along with Him.} The Messenger^ does not have Power to harm or give Guidance Concerning Allah's statement, j% fc \$3 \$} iSay: "It is not in my power to cause you harm, or to bring you to the right path."} 111 At-Jabari 23:668. 121 At-Tabari 23:668.

277Surah 72. Al-linn (18-24) (Part-29 meaning, 'say: I am only a man like you all and I have received revelation. I am only a servant among the servants of Allah. I have no control over the affairs of your guidance or your misguidance. Rather all of these things are referred to Allah.' Then he (the Prophet) says about himself that no one can save him from Allah either. This means, 'if I disobey Allah, then no one would be able to rescue me. from His punishment.' iand nor can I find refuge except in Him.} Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi all said, "No place to escape to." It is only obligatory upon the Messenger to convey the Message Concerning Allah's statement, o;&^ i(Mine is) but conveyancefrom Allah and His Messages,} This is an exception related to the previous statement, 11\$ Si iNone can protect mefrom Allah's punishment,} meaning, 'nothing can save me from Him and rescue me except my conveyance of the Message that He has obligated me to carry out.' This is as Allah says, lifj oil) (j iiljj Ji Jj>l C^ isji S 40 Messenger! Proclaim which has been sent down to youfrom your Lord. And ifyou do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect youfrom mankind.} (5:67) Then Allah says, 4^'jJ "a ns cfj} iand whosoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, for him is the fire of Hell, he shall dwell therein forever.} U1 At-Tabari 23 :669

213 Surah 72. Al-linn (25-28) (Part-29) whether my Lord will appoint for it a distant term."} meaning, a long period of time. In this noble Ayah is an evidence that the Hadith that many of the ignorant people often circulate, which says that the Prophet jg will not remain under the earth more than one thousand years (i.e., the Hour will be before that period) is a baseless lie. We have not seen it in any of the Books (of Hadith). Verily, the Messenger of Allah 3g was asked about the time of the Hour and he would not respond. When Jibril appeared to him in the form of a bedouin Arab, one of the questions he asked the Prophet was, "O Muhammad! Tell me about the Hour?" So the Prophet replied, tjsiijj^ ££ u» *The one questioned about it knows no more than the questioner .» On another occasion when a bedouin Arab called out to the Prophet H in a loud voice saying, "O Muhammad! When will be the Hour?" The Prophet jg said, «? \$ Ui I*) <Woe unto you. Verily, it will occur so what have you prepared for it?n The man replied, "I have not prepared much for it of prayers and fasting, but I love Allah and His Messenger." The Prophet then replied, citi0 *Then you will be with whomever you love.» Anas said, "The Muslims were not happier with anything like they were upon (hearing) this Hadith.'^ Concerning Allah's statement, iThe All-Knower of the Unseen, and He reveals to none His Unseen . Except to a Messenger} This is similar to Allah's statement, I1 * Fath Al-Bari 1 :140. See Al-Bukh&ri no. 6167.

Cj 'll i*J? H ^j} iAnd they will never compass any thing of His knowledge except that which He wills. (2:255) Similarly, Allah says here that He knows the unseen and the seen and that no one of His creation can attain any of His knowledge except that which Allah allows him to have. Thus, Allah says, iThe All-Knower of the Unseen, and He reveals to none His Unseen. Except to a Messenger whom He has chosen, This includes the angelic Messenger and the human Messenger. Then Allah says, J > s' a ' iand then He makes a band of watching guards to march before him and behind him.} meaning, He particularly gives him additional guardian angels who protect him by the command of Allah and they accompany him with that which is with him of Allah's revelation. Thus, Allah says, iTill he knows that they have conveyed the Messages of their Lord. And He surrounds all that which is with them, and He keeps count of all things.} The pronoun 'he' which my iTill he knows} refers to the Prophet jg. Ibn Jarir recorded from Said bin Jubayr that he said concerning the Ayah, & & vA>' .Y. • / *" iThe All-Knower of the Unseen, and He reveals to none His Unseen. Except to a Messenger whom He has chosen, and then He makes a band of watching guards to march before him and behind him.}

"These are four guardians among the angels along with Jibril, iTill he knows) This means Muhammad jg, ^ (^*-1) (Vp-J Lj ixSj (rfj od. Ijti Si J) 4that they have conveyed the Messages of their Lord. And He surrounds all that which is with them, and He keeps count of all things.yW This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. It has also been reported by Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and Yazid bin Abi Habib. 'Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ma'mar, from Qatadah, 4|*frj C-lll-J -»» J iTill he knows that they have conveyed the Messages of their Lord.) "So that the Prophet of Allah would know that the Messengers had conveyed their Messages from Allah and that the angels have protected them and defended them."121 This has also been reported by Said bin Abi 'Arubah from Qatadah, and Ibn Jarir preferred this interpretation.13' Al- Baghawi said, "Ya'qCb recited it as. (in order to be known) this means, so that the people may know that the Messengers had conveyed the Message."4 It also could carry the meaning that the pronoun refers to Allah (i.e., So that He (Allah) may know). This opinion has been mentioned by Ibn Al-Jawzi in Zdd Al-Masir. The meaning of this is that He protects His Messengers through His angels so that they will be able to convey His Messages. He protects what He reveals to them of revelation so that He will

know that they have indeed conveyed the Messages of their Lord. 111 At-Tabari 23:673. ,2 ' 'Abdur-Razzaq 3:323. 13 ' At-Tabari 23 :673. '4 ' Al-Baghawi 4:406.

This is like His statement, <lf <j*i&& c~^' <&*!' I'-i.iL 4Am2 We made the Qiblah which you used to face, only that We know who followed the Messenger from those who would turn on their heels.) (2:143) Allah also said, iVerily, Allah knows those who believe, and that He knows the hypocrites.) (29:11) It should be added to these examples that from Allah's knowledge is that He knows all things before they occur, and this is something definite and certain. Therefore, He says after this, iAnd He surrounds all that which is with them, and He keeps count of all things.)

Surah 73: Al-Muzzammil

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(Chapter - 73) Which was revealed in Makkah mmm avt bc dBais» TSi Mjj iuji 4Ejjjl{^| jii jQi\ jydj »jjfli [il 1V (j/i-Uv JtaiUy ,^1jjiiije.ijo •j@-l<CJJU-o .J / ^ ^ X / ,4 -» s s'&S a*' ^ /n the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. y \$ i :EjEif c&> >• •£* / ; ,jai»i jl 1<CU^ *^' J*U i£ jj ji ffJ&JL c & i Si tj iii y^ivi |>j>> lit) r' pj SV *£ o) 'K :, aJI jLi) <iiy J 2i V v^ifj ips ip<4 '& 41 . O you wrapped up!} 42. Stand (to pray) all night, except a little.} 43. Half of it or less than that, a little.} 44. Or a little more. And Rattil the Qur'an Tartil.} 45. Verily, We shall send down to you a Word Thacfil.} 46. Verily, rising (Nash'ah) at night is better for understanding and more suitable for speech (recitation).} 47. Verily, for you in the day is letigthy Sabh .}

48. And remember the Name of your Lord and (Tabattil) devote yourself to Him with complete devotion. 49. Lord of the east and the west; La ildha ilia Huwa, so take Him as a trustee. The Command to stand at Night (in Prayer) Allah commands His Messenger jg to cease being wrapped up, and this means to be covered during the night. He commands him to get up and stand in prayer to His Lord. This is as Allah says, 4Their sides forsake their beds, to invoke their Lord in fear and hope, and they spend out of what We have bestowed on them.} (32:16) Thus, the Prophet did as Allah ordered him, by standing for prayer at night. This was obligatory upon him alone, as Allah said, / vx - . j ,/y/ / • x /' / • // <; , / / 4And in some parts of the night offer the Saldh with it (the Qur'an), as an additional prayer for you. It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmiid.} (17:79) Here Allah explains how much prayer he should perform. Allah says, 4\$ i©3\$ 1 Ub 40 you wrapped up! Stand all night, except a little.} Ibn 'Abbas, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi all said, 40 you wrapped up!} “This means, O you who are asleep.” Qatadah said, “The one who is wrapped up in his garments.” Concerning Allah's statement. 111 At-Tabari 23:677.

219 Surah 73. Al-Muzzammil (1-9) (Part-29) {Half of it} means, instead of the whole night. Jj j* o''' JT 4A little less than that, or a little more.} meaning, “We have commanded you to stand in prayer for half of the night, either a little more than it or a little less. There is no hardship on you concerning that (slight increase or decrease). The Way of reciting the Qur'an Concerning Allah's statement, 4 • iAnd Rattil the Qur'an Tartil.} meaning, recite it slowly, for that will help in understanding the Qur'an and contemplating it. This is how the Prophet jg used to recite. 'A'ishah said, “He (the Prophet) used to recite the chapter slowly, so much so that it would be longer than chapters that were actually longer than it.” 111 In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is recorded from Anas that he was asked about the recitation of the Messenger of Allah jg, so he replied, “He used to elongate the letters.” Then he (Anas) recited, in the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} (1:1) and he elongated “In the Name of Allah,”

and he elongated “The Most Gracious,” and he elongated “The Most Merciful.”¹² Ibn Jurayj reported from Ibn Abi Mulaykah, who narrated from Umm Salamah that she was asked about the recitation of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, so she said, “He used to pause in his recitation, verse by verse. >#- m Muslim 1 :507. 2| Fath Al-Bari 8 :709

in the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. All praise is Allah's, the Lord of all that exists. The Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. The Only Owner of the Day of Recompense.) (1:1-4) This was recorded by Ahmad, Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi. We have already mentioned the Hadiths which prove the recommendation of slow rhythmic recitation and beautification of the voice while reciting at the beginning of this Tafsir. For example, the Hadith which states, *يا أيها الذين آمنوا زينوا القرآن بأصواتكم* and the Hadith, “*هو ليس منكم من لا يحسن تلاوة القرآن*” and the Hadith, “*يُجْلَى لِي جَوْشَنُ كَرِيمٌ*”⁵¹ Verily, he has been given this windpipe from the windpipes of the family of Dawud.[^] Referring to Abu Musa. Abu Mitsa replied, “If I knew that you had been listening to my recitation, I would have truly beautified it for you.” It has been narrated from Ibn Mas‘ud that he said, “Do not scatter the (recitation of) Qur’an out like the scattering of sand, and do not rush through it like the hasty recitation of poetry. Stop at its amazing parts and make your heart move with it. None of you should let his concern be to reach the end of the chapter.” This has been recorded by Al-Baghawi.^{*51} Al-Bukhari recorded from Abi Wa’il that he said, “A man came to Ibn Mas‘ud and said, ‘I read the Mufassal chapters (from Qaf to An-Nas) last night in one unit of prayer.’ Ibn Mas‘ud said. This is rushing like the haste of reciting poetry. Verily, I know *** Ahmad 6:302, Abu Dawud 4:294, and Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :241 ,> Fath Al-Bari 13:527. 131 Fath Al-Bari 13:510. [41 Fath Al-Bari 8:710. (s) Ma‘alim At-Tanzil 8:215.

the pairs (of chapters) that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to combine between them (in prayer).’ Then he mentioned twenty chapters from the Mufassal chapters, and said that the Prophet ﷺ used to recite two in each prayer unit.” The Magnificence of the Qur’an Allah then said, *وإنا نزلناه في ليلة القدر*. > Al-Hasan and Qatadah both said, “The actions with it.” It has also been said that it means it will be heavy at the time of its revelation due to its magnificence. This is similar to what Zayd bin Thabit said. He said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ received some revelation while his thigh was on top of my thigh, and my thigh was almost crushed due to it.”^{*21} Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr that he said, “I asked the Prophet ‘O Messenger of Allah! Do you feel anything when revelation comes (to you)?’ The Messenger of Allah ﷺ replied. «I hear a ringing and then I remain quiet when that occurs. There has not been a single time that revelation has come to me except that I thought that my soul was about to be taken (death)»”¹³¹ Ahmad was alone in narrating this. In the beginning of Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is recorded from ‘A’ishah that Al-Harith bin Hisham asked the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, “How does the revelation come to you?” The Prophet ﷺ replied, ¹¹¹ Fath Al-Bari 2 :298 Fath Al-Bari 8:108. Zayd was sitting with the Prophet ﷺ writing down the revelation as the Prophet ﷺ was dictating it to him. See Al-Bukhari no. 4592. Ahmad 2 :222 . There are some deficiencies in its chain of narration Some scholars consider it authentic

«يُعْطِي سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ جَلِيلًا كَمَا يُعْطِي» Sometimes it comes to me like the ringing of a bell, and it is most severe upon me. Then this state passes away from me after I have grasped what is inspired. Sometimes the angel comes to me in the form of a man and talks to me and I grasp whatever he says» ‘A’ishah added,

“Verily, I saw him receiving revelation and I noticed the sweat dropping from his forehead on a very cold day as the revelation ended.” This is the wording recorded by Al-Bukhari. ’ Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘A’ishah that she said, “If the Messenger of Allah received any revelation while he was on his riding animal, it would begin moving its Jircin intensely.”*2 * The Jircin is the bottom of the neck. Ibn Jarir chose the interpretation that it (the revelation) is heavy in both ways simultaneously. This is as ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, “Just as it is heavy in this world, it will also be heavy on the Day of Judgement in the Scales.” The Virtue of standing at Night for Prayer Allah says, fy’j ^ Jt\$ &£ Vfr iVerily, rising (Ndshi’ah) at night is better for understanding and more suitable for speech (recitation).} ‘Umar, Ibn ‘Abbas and Ibn Zubayr, all said, “The entire night is Ndshi’ah.”^ Mujahid and others said the same.*4 ’ It is said “Nasha’a” when a person stands at night to pray. In one narration from Mujahid he said, “(It is) after ‘Isha’ (prayer).” *5’ This was also said by Abu Mijlaz, Qatadah, Salim, Abu Hazim and Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir.’6 The point is that Ndshi’ah of the night refers to its hours and its times, every 111 FathAl-Bari 1:25. ’ Ahmad 6:118. ’ At-Tabari 23:683. ’ At-Tabari 23 :682 ’ At-Tabari 23:682. ’ At-Tabari 23:683.

hour of it is called Nashi’ah, so it refers to the periods of time. The purpose of this is that standing at night (for prayer) is better for training the heart and the tongue, and more conducive to recitation. Thus, Allah says, 4% {> j-J 4is better for understanding and more suitable for speech (recitation).} meaning, more comprehensive for the matter of performing the recitation and better for understanding it than in the recitation of the day. This is because the daytime is the time for people to disperse and move about, to raise voices and be lively. Al-Hafiz Abu Yala Al-Mawsili said, “Ibrahim bin Said Al- Jawhari told us that Abu Usamah told us that Al-A’mash informed us that Anas bin Malik recited this Ayah as: (^J iij jdiJ LiU Sj) (Verily, rising at night is better for understanding and more correct for the speech. So a man said to him, *We recite it; imore suitable for speech}.’ So Anas said to him, ‘Most correct (Aswab), most suitable (Aqwam), the best for preparation (Ahya’) and similar words are all the same (in meaning).’ ”11 Thus, Allah continues saying, 4& k iVerily, for you in the day is lengthy Sabh.} Ibn ‘Abbas, ‘Ikrimah and “Ata’ bin Abi Muslim, all said, “Leisure time and sleep.”121 Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Mujahid, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi’ bin Anas and Sufyan Ath-Thawri, all said, “A long amount of leisure time.” Qatadah said, “Leisure, aspirations and activities.” ‘Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said concerning the statement, -ffi 4^ 111 MusnadAbu Ya’la 7 :88 . At-Tabari 23 :686 , and Al-Qurtubi 19 :42

224 TafsJr Ibn Kathir iVerily, for you in the day is lengthy Sabh.} “This means for your needs. Therefore, leave the night open for your religious devotion. Allah said this when the (voluntary) night prayer was obligatory. Then, Allah blessed His servants, lightened the matter and removed its obligation.” Then he recited, jdi }} iStand (to pray) all night, except a little.} to the end of the Ayah, then he recited, ^ fji! vtbJ Jtu } 4Verily, your Lord blows that you do stand less than two- thirds of the night, or half of it.} (73:20) until he reached, 4So recite of it what is easy.} (73:20) and Allah says, UIJL* viLj o’ till i&ili *4^ .a >v4 i’ JjJt irijy 4And Tahajjud in some parts of the night (also offer the Saldh with it), as an additional prayer for you. It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud.^ (17:79) In fact, this is as true as what he (‘Abdur-Rahman) said, The proof for this view is what Imam Ahmad recorded in his Musnad, that Said bin Hisham divorced his wife and then traveled to Al-Madlnah in order to sell some property he had with her. He intended to use its money to buy an

animal and a weapon and then go for Jihad against the Romans until he died. In the process of this he met a group of his people and they informed him that a group of six men from his people had intended that in the time of the Messenger of Allah upon which he said, *AMabari* 23:686. See the explanation in volume six

«Is there not for you all an excellent example in me?» So he forbade them from that and made them testify that they would take their wives back. Then he (Said) returned to us and informed us that he went to Ibn ‘Abbas and asked him about the Witr (prayer). Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Shall I not inform you of the person who is the most knowledgeable person on the earth about the Witr prayer of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ?” He said, “Yes.” Ibn ‘Abbas then said, “Go to ‘A’ishah and ask her, then return to me and inform me of what she tells you.” He said, “Then I went to Hakim bin Aflah and requested him to go with me to her. But he said, *I do not want to be near her. Verily, I forbade her from saying anything concerning these two parties (the parties of ‘Ali and Mu’awiyah), but she refused and continued being involved with them (in their conflict).’ So I adjured him by Allah, so he came with me and we entered upon her (in her house).” So she said, “Is this the Hakim that I know?” He (Hakim) said, “Yes.” Then she said, “Who is this that is with you?” He said, “Said bin Hisham.” She said, “Who is Hisham?” He said, “He is Ibn ‘Amir.” She then asked Allah to have mercy upon him (‘Amir). Then she said, “Yes, ‘Amir was a true man.” Then I (Said) said, “O Mother of the believers! Inform me about the character of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.” She replied, “Have you not read the Qur’an?” I said, “Of course.” Then she said, “Verily, the character of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was the Qur’an.” I was about to stand and leave, but then I remembered to ask about the night prayer of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. I said, “O Mother of the believers! Inform me about the night prayer of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.” She said, “Have you not read the Surah, 40 which is wrapped up.” I said, “Of course.” She then said, “Verily, Allah made standing at night (for prayer) obligatory at the beginning of this Surah, So the Messenger of Allah and his Companions stood for an entire year during the night (in prayer) until their feet swelled. Allah held back the revelation of the end of this Surah for twelve months. Then, Allah revealed the lightening of this burden at the end of this Surah. Then, the standing for night prayer became voluntary after it used to be obligatory.”

I was about to leave when I remembered to ask her about the Witr prayer of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. So I said, “O Mother of the believers! Inform me about the Witr prayer of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.” She said, “We used to prepare his Siwak (toothstick) for him and his ablution water, and Allah would awaken him whenever He wished to awaken him during the night. Then, he would clean his teeth with the Siwak and perform ablution. Then, he would pray eight (Rak'ahs) units of prayer and he would not sit during them except at the end of the eighth one. At this point he would sit and remember his Lord the Most High, and supplicate to Him. Afterwards he would stand without saying the greeting of peace (Taslim). He would then pray a ninth unit of prayer and then sit. He would remember Allah Alone and then supplicate to Him (during this sitting). Then, he would say the greetings of peace (to conclude the prayer) making it audible to us. Then, he would pray two more units of prayer after this salutation of peace, while he would be sitting. So these are eleven units of prayer, O my son. Then, when he became older and heavier, he would perform Witr prayer with seven units of prayer, and then he would pray two extra units of prayer after them while sitting after the salutation of peace. So these are nine units of prayer, O my son. Whenever the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to pray a particular prayer, he liked to

remain consistent in its performance. If he would ever be preoccupied from performing the night prayer by oversleeping, pain or illness, he would pray twelve units of supererogatory prayer during the day. I do not know of Allah's Prophet ever reciting the entire Qur'an in one night before morning nor did he fast an entire month other than the month of Ramadan." So I went to Ibn 'Abbas and told him what she had said. Ibn 'Abbas then said, "She has spoken truthfully and if I had went to her house I would have remained until she spoke directly to me and I could see her lips moving."¹¹ This is how Imam Ahmad recorded this narration in its entirety. Muslim also recorded similarly in his Sahib.¹² Ibn Jarir recorded from Abu 'Abdur-Rahman that he said, 111 Ahmad 6:53. 121 Muslim 1:512.

227 Surah 73. Al-Muzzammil (1-9) (Part-29) "When the Ayah <0 you wrapped.) (73:1) was revealed, the people stood in night prayer for an entire year until their feet and shins swelled. This continued until Allah revealed, 4*-; jLm U ^ 4So recite of it what is easy.) (73:20) Then the people relaxed. ,1] Al-Hasan Al-Basri and As-Suddi both said the same. 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said concerning Allah's statement, lis £ :T:*i j# j) iStand (to pray) all night, except a little. Half of it or less than that, a little.) (73:2,3) "This became difficult on the believers. Then Allah lightened the matter for them and had mercy on them when He revealed after this. 4He kttows that there will be some among you sick, others traveling through the land, seeking of Allah's bounty.) until Allah says, ih. 'jl u \::}l) 4So, recite you of the Qur'an as much as may be easy for you.) (73:20) So Allah made the matter easy - and unto Him is due all praise - and he did not make matters difficult."³ Then Allah says, 4And remember the Name of your Lord and (Tabattai) devote yourself to Him with complete devotion.) m At-Tabari 23:679. [21 At-Tabari 23 :680 At-Tabari 23 :679

Him out for worship, you should also single Him out for reliance. Therefore, take Him as a guardian and trustee. This is as Allah says in another Ayah, 4^ iSo worship Him and rely upon him.) (1 1:123) It is also similar to His statement, Atyj Ati} 4You (Alone)we worship , and you (Alone)we ask for help>(1:5) The Ayat with this meaning are numerous. They contain the command to make worship and acts of obedience exclusively for Allah, and to rely solely upon Him. \fSk JjJy U jt jA[]} Uj*j li tiLly 'tflsd llTjJ rn di &1 tfcj \ <4m& fc# « <5 4 4SS **.; <saaj# <®£b 'fin*4 afes sat @fe ssyr 410 . And be patient with what they say, and keep away from them in a good way> ill. And leave Me alone to deal with the deniers, those who are in possession of good things of life. And give them respite for a little.} 412. Verily, with Us are Anka, and Jahtma .} 413. And a food that chokes, and a painful torment.} 114. On the Day when the earth and the mountains will (Tarjufu) shake, and the mountains will be a heap of sand poured out.} 115. Verily, We have sent to you a Messenger to be a witness over you, as We did send a Messenger to Fir'awn.} 116. But Fir'awn disobeyed the Messenger; so We seized him with a severe punishment.} 417. Then how can you protect yourselves from the punishment, if you disbelieve, on a Day that will make the children gray-headed?}

231 Surah 73. Al-Muzzammil (10-18) (Part-29) \$and Jahim This is a blazing fire. 4*^ 'i C\tli>j} iAnd a food that chokes,} Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means it will get stuck in the throat and it will not enter or come out."¹¹ iand a painful torment. On the Day when the earth and the mountains will (TarjuJ) shake,} meaning, they will quake. i:py, <1 jat 4%} iAnd the mountains will be a heap of sand poured out.} meaning, they will become like hills of sand after they had been firm rocks. Then they will be utterly destroyed and nothing will remain of them. This will occur until the entire earth becomes a flat

land and no curvature will be seen in it. Thus, there will be no valleys and no hills. This means that no part of it will be low or elevated. Your Messenger[^] is like the Messenger to Fir'awn, and You know what happened to Fir'awn Then addresses the disbelievers of the Quraysh, and along with them the rest of mankind, 'if-j £4l u£j iVerily, We have sent to you a Messenger to be a witness over you,} meaning, witnessing your deeds. ijiJ * JI li-j1 %} ias We did send a Messenger to Fir'awn. But Fir'awn disobeyed the Messenger; so We seized him with a severe punishment.} U1 i-L) a\} At-Tabari 23 :691

4severe punishment} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi, and Ath-Thawri said that this means severe. ' This means, "you should beware of denying this Messenger, lest you be afflicted by that which befell Fir'awn. Allah seized him with the seizing of One Mighty and Powerful.' This is as Allah says, cpift 0®B ai 4So Allah seized him with punishment for his last and first transgression ,} (79:25) Therefore, you will be even more deserving of destruction and ruin if you deny your Messenger, because your Messenger is more noble and a greater than Prophet Musa, the son of 'Imran.' This has been reported from Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid. The Threat ofthe Day ofJudgement Allah says, 4iff ojiU iJISH} 4Then how can you protect yourselvesfrom the punishment, if you disbelieved, on a Day that will make the children gray- headed?} Ibn Jarir quoted in the recitation ofIbn Mas'ud: "How can you, O people, fear a Day that makes the children grey-headed, ifyou disbelieve inAllah and do not testify toHim?"121 So the first interpretation would mean, 'how can you attain safety for yourselves from the Day of this great horror if you disbelieve?' It could imply the meaning, 'how can you all attain piety if you disbelieve in the Day of Judgement and reject it.' Both of these meanings are good. However, the first interpretation is closer to the truth. And Allah knows best. The meaning of Allah's statement, o'jji feZ &j} 40n a Day that will make the children gray-headed?} is that this willhappendue to the severity ofits horrors, its earth- m At-Tabari 23:693. 121 At-Tabari 23:694.

233Surah 73. Al-Muzzammil (19-20) (Part-29 quakes and its distur- bing confusion. This is. when Allah will say to Adam, "Send a group to the Fire."Adam will say, "How many?" Allah will then reply, "From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine to the Fire, and one to Paradise." Then Allah says, i.% iWhereon the heaven will be cleft asunder?) Al-Hasan and Qatadah both said, "This means, because of it (the Day of Judge- ment), due to its severity and its horror." Then Allah says, f&j of))His promise is certainly to be accomplished.) meaning, the promise of this Day will be fulfilled. This means it will occur and there is no way around it, and it will come to pass and there is no avoiding it. ^ mm II! 35 00j^^;0^^s0*££ti *i -V

419. Verily, this is an admonition, therefore whosoever ivills, let him take a path to His Lord!} 420. Verily, your Lord knows that you do stand a little less than two-thirds of tite night, or half the night, or a third of the night, and also a party of those with you. And Allah measures the night and the day. He knows that you are unable to pray the whole night, so He has turned to you. So, recite you of the Qur'an as much as may be easy for you . He knows that there will be some among you sick, others traveling through the land, seeking of Allah's bounty, yet others fighting in Allah's cause. So recite as much of the Qur'an as may be easy, and perform Salah and give ZakSh, and lend to Allah a handsome loan. And whatever good you send before you for yourselves, you will certainly find it with Allah, better and greater in reward. And seekforgiveness ofAllah. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most- Merciful.} This is a Surah that Men of Sound Understanding receiveAdmonition from Allah says, 4Verily, this} meaning,

this Surah. 4*^>=>±} 4an admonition,} meaning, men of understanding receive admonition from it. Thus, Allah says. 4therefore whosoever wills, let him take a path to His Lord.} meaning, from those whom Allah wills that they be guided. This is similar to the stipulation that Allah mentions in another Surah, 4ffg£& oIT 'if l\ if£ J% SjiES Cj} 4But you cannot will, unless Allah wills. Verily Allah is Ever All-Knowing, Al-Wise.} (76:30)

Abrogation of the Obligation to offer the Night Prayer¹¹¹ and a Mention of its Valid Excuses Then Allah says, ^ 9/ »<• , / •• /*» / i f 'Jj ' , /j/ ; \ 4 Verily, your Lord knows that you do stand a little less than two-thirds of the night, or half the night, or a third of the night, and also a party of those with you.} meaning, sometimes like this and sometimes like that, and all of these are done unintentionally. However, you all are not able to be consistent with the night prayer Allah has commanded you, because it is difficult for you. Thus, Allah says, 4And Allah measures the night and the day.} meaning, sometimes the night and day are equal, and sometimes one of them will be longer or shorter than the other. J J £} }He knows that you are unable to pray the whole night,} meaning, the obligation which He prescribed for you. 4So, recite you of the Qur'an as much as may be easy.} meaning, without specification of any set time. This means, stand and pray during the night as much as is easy (for you). Allah uses the term recitation (Qira'ah) to mean prayer (Saldh). This is as Allah says in Surah Subhan (Al-Isra), %} 4And offer your Saldh neither aloud} (17:110) meaning, your recitation. cite 'Jj} l 1 As mentioned earlier, this refers to Qiy&m Al-Layl or what is commonly called Tahajjud.

iNor in low voice.} (17:1 10) Then Allah says. * < ' ..iff . f * •" f > ' S' '*•1 ^ > fa* i //V ^ sH1* # cpS* ' 4 u->V^i o' 4He knows that there will be some among you sick, others traveling through the land, seeking of Allah's bounty, yet others fighting in Allah's cause.} meaning, He knows that there will be people of this nation who will have excuses for not praying the (voluntary) night prayer. They are those who are ill and therefore they are not able to perform it, and those who are traveling in the land seeking the bounty of Allah in business and trade, and others who will be busy with that which is more important to them. An example of this is going on expeditions to fight in the way of Allah. This Ayah, rather, this entire Surah was revealed in Makkah even though fighting was not legislated until after it was revealed. Thus, it is among the greatest of the signs of prophethood, because it informs about unseen matters of the future. Thus, Allah says, j-j; £ \£jfb} iSo recite as much of the Qur'an as may be easy,} meaning, stand and pray at night whatever is easy for you to do of it. Allah said; i>.j iand perform Saldh and give Zakah,} meaning, establish your obligatory prayers and pay your obligatory Zakah. This is a proof for those who say that Zakah was made obligatory in Makkah, but the various amounts of Nisabl and how much was to be given was clarified in Al- Madlnah. And Allah knows best. Ibn 'AbbSs, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others from the Salaf have said, "Verily, this Ayah abrogated the standing for prayer at night that Allah previously made ¹¹¹ The minimum amount requiring Zakah to be paid on wealth.

obligatory for the Muslims." It has been confirmed in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah jg said to a man, Aj ^jjj ^\p> (iFive obligatory prayers during a day and a night (are obligatory The man said, "Is there anything other than this (of prayer) that is obligatory upon me?" The Messenger of Allah jg replied, jf Vj iV «No, except what you may do voluntarilyV2 TheCommand to give Charity and do Good Deeds Allah says, iand lend to Allah a handsome loan.} meaning, from charitable donations. For

verily, Allah will reward for this the best and most abundant of rewards. This is as Allah says, S l2»y Sit <j>Ju '» j*} iWho is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan so that He may multiply it to him many times?} (2:245) Then Allah says, A A ' 5&kW& iAnd whatever good you send before you for yourselves, you will certainly find it with Allah, better and greater in reward.} meaning, for all that you send before yourselves, you will get it (back) and it will be better than what you kept for yourselves in the worldly life. Al-Hafiz Abu Yala Al-Mawsili reported from Al-Harith bin Suwayd, from 'Abdullah that Messenger of Allah & said, JU j. 4\4^ feU *'* At-Tabari 23 :679 , 680 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 : 322 * Fath Al-Bari 1 :130, and Muslim 1 :41

'Which of you hold his wealth to be more beloved to him than the wealth of his heir?'« They said, "O Messenger of Allah! There is not a single one of us who does not hold his wealth to be more beloved to him than the wealth of his heir." The Messenger of Allah jg then said, fljjJjjj U Know what you are saying They replied, "What do we know other than this, O Messenger of Allah?" He then said, 'The wealth of one of you is only that which he sends forth, and the wealth of his heir is that which he leaves behind. Al-Bukhari also recorded this HadfthJ2 Then Allah says, iAnd seek forgiveness of Allah. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most-Merciful meaning, remember Him and seek forgiveness from Him often for all of your matters. For verily. He is Most Forgiving, Most Merciful to whoever seeks His forgiveness.

Surah 74: Al-Muddaththir

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Muddaththir

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6185–6206]

(Chapter - 74) Which was revealed in Makkah it . 0 you enveloped in garments!} 42 . Arise and warn!} 43 . And magnify your Lord!} 44. And purify your garments!} 45. And keep away from Ar-Rujz!} 46. And give not a thing in order to have more.} il . And be patient for the sake of your Lord!} i8. Then, when the Naqur is sounded.} 49. Truly, that Day will be a Hard Day.} ilO. Far from easy for the disbelievers.} The First Ayat to be revealed after ‘Read!’¹ 11 It has been confirmed in the Sahuh Al-Bukhari and SahOi Muslim on the authority of Abu Salamah that Jabir bin ‘Abdullah informed him that he heard the Messenger of Allah speaking about the time period (of the pause in) revelation. The Prophet sH said. JjO kjllDI J’JiSjS* cJS’J tUUI ly.^ cJLw il^ That is , the beginning of SURat Al-’Alaq (96)

U-Ul ^ li)i tjLLUl ud_A*j p-^ (Jl *~? *d<Cj -TviSj «3Cju , r^jjiw 5 4>i Jj»U ‘ijtj^j q&j P >55 £|3ji£» «The« the revelation ceased coming to me for a period of time. Then, while I was walking, I heard a voice from the sky. So I lifted my gaze towards the sky to see the same angel who had come to me, sitting on a chair between the sky and the earth. So I fled from him a short distance before I fell down to the ground. Then I came to my family and said to them, ‘Wrap me up, wrap me up! So, they wrapped me up! Then Allah revealed, 40 you wrapped up! Arise and warn! And magnify your Lord. And purify your garments. And keep away from Ar-Rujz!} After this, the revelation started coming strongly and frequently in successionJ They both (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) recorded this Hadlth by way of Az-Zuhri.¹²¹ At-Tabarani recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “Verily, Al-Walxd bin Al-Mughlah prepared some food for the Quraysh. So when they had eaten from it he said, “What do you have to say about this man?’ Some of them said, ‘Tie is a magician.’ Others said, ‘He is not a magician.’ Then some of them said, ‘He is a soothsayer.’ But others said, ‘Tie is not a soothsayer.’ Some of them said, ‘He is a poet.’ But others said, ‘He is not a poet.’ Some of them said, ‘This is magic from that of old.’ Thus, they eventually all agreed that it was magic from ancient times. Then, when this news reached the Prophet jg, he became grieved, covered his head and wrapped himself up. This is when Allah revealed, ir*5 "S >35 cf 40 you enveloped in garments! Arise and warn! And magnify 111 Ahmad 3:325. Path Al-BCui 1 :37, and Muslim 1 :143.

your Lord (Allah)! And purify your garments! And keep away from Ar-Rujz (the idols)! And give not a thing in order to have more (or consider not your deeds of obedience to Allah as a favour to Him). And be patient for the sake of your Lord (i.e., perform your duty to Allah)!}W Concerning Allah’s statement, ‘) iArise and warn!} means, prepare to go forth with zeal and warn the people. With this the Prophet ^ attained messengership just as he attained prophethood with the first revelation. iAnd magnify your

Lord!} to declare the greatness of Him. Al- 'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas; iAnd purify your garments!} "This means, do not let your garments that you wear be from earnings that are unlawful." It has also been said, "Do not wear your clothes in disobedience." *21 Muhammad bin Sirin said, 131 iAnd purify your garments!} "This means clean them with water." 41 Ibn Zayd said, "The idolators would not clean themselves, so Allah commanded him to clean himself and his garments." *5 ' This view was preferred by Ibn Jarir. *6 Said bin Jubayr said, #3 *** At-Tabarani 1 1 :125 . The chain for this narration is weak. There are other versions that may support it. See the discussion after Ayah no . 25 that follows [2 At-Tabari 24:11. [3 At-Tabari 24:11. * At-Tabari 24:12. |s| At-Tabari 24:12. * At-Tabari 24:12.

iAnd purify your garments!} "This means purify your heart and your intentions." Muhammad bin KaT) Al-Qurazi and Al-Hasan Al-Basri both said, "And beautify your character." Concerning Allah's statement, 40A&&& iAnd keep away from Ar-Rujz!} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas, Ar-Rujz are idols, so keep away from them." 111 Similar to this was said by Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Qatadah, Az-Zuhri and Ibn Zayd, "Verily, it is the idols." 12 This is like Allah's statement, 4i*iiEij 'ij iii g?' ^1' 40 Prophet! have Taqwa of Allah, and obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites. (33 : 1) and Allah's statement. iAnd Musa said to his brother Hariin : "Replace me among my people, act well and follow not way of the corrupters (7 :142) Then Allah says, iAnd give not a thing in order to have more.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Do not give any gift seeking to get (back in return) more than it." Khusayf reported from Mujahid; iAnd give not a thing (Tamnun) in order to have more.} "Do not slacken in seeking more good. Tamnun in the language of the Arabs means to become weak." 13 ' Concerning Allah's statement. 111 At-Tabari 24:13. 121 At-Tabari 24:13. 131 At-Tabari 24:16.

244 Tafslr Ibn Kafhlr iAnd be patient for the sake of your Lord!} meaning, make your patience with their harms be for the Face of your Lord, the Mighty and Majestic. This was stated by Mujahid . 111 Ibrahim An-Nakhal said, "Be patient in your giving for the sake of Allah, the Mighty and Majestic." 121 Reminding of the Day of Judgement Concerning Allah's statement, ' 'Sli iThen, when the Naqur is sounded. Truly, that Day will be a Hard Day -far from easy for the disbelievers Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ash-Shabi, Zayd bin Aslam, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ar-RabT bin Anas, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd, all said, iNaqur} "It is the Trumpet." 131 Mujahid said, "It is in the shape of a horn." 141 Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Abu Said Al-Ashaj told them that Asbat bin Muhammad related to them from Mutarrif, from 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, from Ibn 'Abbas, <©5> 4%# iThen, when the Trumpet is sounded.} The Messenger of Allah || said, if* O^ill Ji «How can I be comfortable when the one with the horn has placed it in his mouth, leaned his forehead forward, and is waiting to be commanded so that he can blow?» The Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg said, "What do you command us, O Messenger of Allah?" He replied. At-Tabari 24 :16. 121 Al-Baghawi 4 :414 131 At-Tabari 24:18. At-Tabari 24:18.

(iSay: "Allah is sufficient for us, and what an excellent Trustee He is. We put our trust in Allah .")» It has been recorded like this by Imam Ahmad on the authority of Asbat. Concerning Allah's statement, i'Zp/ jr? *(£ it*4*^ iTruly, that Day will be a Hard Day.) meaning, severe. %- f) iFar from easy for the disbelievers.) meaning, it will not be- easy for them. This is as Allah says, iThe disbelievers will say: "This a Hard Day.") (54:8) We have reported from Zurarah bin Awfa, the judge of Al- Basrah, that he lead the people in the morning prayer and he recited this Surah. Then, when he reached Allah's

statement. 4Then, when the Ndqur is sounded. Truly, that Day will be a Hard Day -farfrom easyfor the disbelievers.) he made a moaning sound and then he fell down dead. May Allah have mercy on him.'2' \$ i>4v Q&& 0\$ 'fa % &Z &JSL S3 £) % \$&£ ftfc (&zg \$\$ tg f.\% <3p } 111. LeaveMe alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely.) 112. And then granted him resources in abundance.) 113. And Children attending.) I1 * Ahmad no. 326. 121 Al-Hakim 2:507.

246 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 414. And made life smooth and comfortablefor him. 415. After all that he desires that I should give more. 416. Nay! Verily, he has been opposing OurAyat.> 417. I shallforce him to Sa'iid! 418. Verily, he thought and plotted 419. So let him be cursed, how he plotted! 420. And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! 421 . Then he thought. 422. Then hefrowned and he looked in a bad tempered way; 423. Then he turned back, and was proud. 424. Then he said: "This is nothing but magic from that of old, 425. "This is nothing but the word ofa human being!" 426. I will cast him into Saqar. 427. And what will make you know (exactly) what Saqar is? 428. It spares not, nor does it leave (anything)! 429. Scorchingfor the humans! 430. Over it are nineteen. AThreat forWhoever claims that the Qur'an is Magic Allah threatens this wicked person whom He has favored with the blessings of this world, yet he is ungrateful for the blessings of Allah and he meets them with disbelief (in Allah) and rejection of His Ayat. He invents lies against Allah's Ayat and claims that they are the words of a man. Allah recounts to him His favors upon him when He says, 4LeaveMe alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely. meaning, he came out of the womb of his mother alone, without any wealth or children. Then, Allah provided him with 4resources in abundance.* meaning, vast and abundant. Allah then made for him,

4And children attending.} Mujahid said, "They are not absent." 111 This means that they are present with him. They do not travel for business and trade. Rather, their servants and hired workers handle all of that for them while they are sitting with their father. He enjoys their company and delights in being with them. According to what has been stated by As-Suddi, Abu Malik and 'Asim bin 'Umar bin Qatadah, they were thirteen (children) in number.*2 * Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid said that they were ten.*3 * This was a great blessing in their living with him. 4And made life smooth and comfortablefor him.} meaning, 1 made possible for him to amass wealth, luxuries and other than that.' 4After all that he desires that I should give more. Nay! Verily, he has been opposing Our Ayat.} meaning, obstinate. This refers to his ungratefulness for his blessings after knowing (these blessings). Allah says. 41 shall force him to Sa'ud!} Qatadah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Sa'ud is a rock in Hell that the disbeliever will be dragged across on his face."*4 * As-Suddi said, "Sa'ud. is a slippery rock in Hell that he will be forced to climb." Mujahid said, 41 shallforce him to Sa'ud!} "This is a harsh portion of the torment."|5 ' Qatadah said, "It is *** Al-Baghawi 4 :414. * Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8 :329 , where similar is reported to have been said by Abu Malik. The "they" in question refers to the children of Al-Walid bin Al-Mughirah accordingly. 131 At-Tabari 24:21. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :331 151 At-Tabari 24:23.

iThen he said: "This is nothing but magicfrom that ofold."\$ meaning, 'this is magic that Muhammad received from those who were before him, and he is merely saying what he got from them.' This is why he said, <wf\$& 'Jl& iThis is nothing but the word ofa human being!} meaning, it is not the Words of Allah. The person who is mentioned in this discussion is Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlrah Al-Makhzumi. He

was one of the chiefs of the Quraysh - may Allah curse him. Among the narrations about this is what was reported by Al-'Awfi from Ibn 'Abbas. He (Ibn 'Abbas) said, "Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlah entered the house of Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhafah and asked him about the Qur'an. When Abu Bakr informed him about it, he left and went to the Quraysh saying, "What a great thing this is that Ibn Abi Kabshah is saying. I swear by Allah that it is not poetry, nor magic, nor the prattling of insanity. Verily, his speech is from the Words of Allah!' So when a group of the Quraysh heard this they gathered and said, *By Allah, if Al-Walid converts (to Islam) all of the Quraysh will convert.' When Abu Jahl bin Hisham heard this he said, *By Allah, I will deal with him for you.' So he went to Al-Walid's house and entered upon him. He said to Al-Walid, 'Don't you see that your people are collecting charity for you?' Al-Walid replied, "Don't I have more wealth and children than they do?' Abu Jahl answered, They are saying that you only went to Ibn Abi Quhafah's house so that you can get some of his food.' Al-Walid then said, "Is this what my tribe is saying? Nay, by Allah, I am not seeking to be close to Ibn Abi Quhafah, nor Tjmar, nor Ibn Abi Kabshah. And his speech is only inherited magic of old.' So Allah revealed to His Messenger sg, }Leave me alone with whom I created lonely.} until His statement, m He meant the Prophet jg.

250 Tafstr Ibn KathTr \$£ 'i} ilt spares not, nor does it leave (anything)!}'^ Qatadah said, "They claim that he (Al-Walid) said, *By Allah, I thought about what the man says, and it is not poetry. Verily, it has a sweetness and it is truly elegant. Verily, it is exalted and it is not overcome. And I have no doubt that it is magic.' So Allah revealed, iSo let him be cursed, how he plotted!} \$Then hefirmvned and he looked in a bad tempered way.} He contracted his eyes together and scowled."121 Allah says, 41 will cast him into Saqar.} meaning, 1 will engulf him in it from all his sides.' Then Allah says, \$And what will make you know (exactly) what Saqar is?} This is to give fright and emphasis to its matter. Then Allah explains this by His saying, ilt spares not, nor does it leave (anything)!} meaning, it eats their flesh, veins, nerves and their skins. Then their organs will be changed into something else. They will remain in this (form), not living or dying. This was stated by Ibn Buraydah, Abu Sinan and others. 131 Concerning Allah's statement, At-Tabari 24:24. See also Al-Hakim 2:507, who graded it Sahih and Adh-Dhahabi agreed. And in Dala'il An-Nubuwwah by Al-Bayhaqi 2:198,199. Many of the scholars of Hadlth consider the best of chains for this story to be Mursal. [2] At-Tabari 24:25. I3 ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :332

^pij\ U_ij&(jl ^ y?0 c\$luj/ 'Q- ^jiS}\l\i\j^/sii.yj%^\,x'i' " . a&j , *.ff.- --?:?. «4>» ?' ' »"?f' !' cfc\$t&&£\$ZfciS\ /Jj|. ^ //•{ ^Jv + * *S f. ^^ ^ -V»J 4:5^ ty> iScorching for the humans!\$ Mujahid said, "This means for the skin." Qatadah said, i^j& tffr 4Scorching for the humans!\$ "This means burning the skin." Ibn 'Abbas said, "Burning the skin of man."*21 Concerning Allah's statement, 4;\$s;s lei i£> iOver it are nineteen .)> meaning, the first of the guardians of Hell. They are magnificent in (their appearance) and harsh in their character. ivj ij' i>j& USi V) G^r Cj '&fo. •tfl jG)f .!<?^ ?frl Cj^ Jv* (*r^* 4 4>V.J v^' 'jy' ijJ' X) IJ>C £rOJl jl^ij ^"1 *%> Jj-^ i^5 j* Jjio .>• li* J^* <4^" Vi* U^j *if S'ji uC *rl ^'>^ £^5 H ^ tsSi V) J» £J S» 4'^^: i' J^ Si £l (I £j; ^31. And We have set none but angels as guardians of the Fire. And We have fixed their number only as a trial for the disbelievers, in order that the People of the Scripture may arrive at a certainty and that the believers may increase in faith, and m At-Tabari 24:27. Al-Tabari 24:28.

252 TafsTr Ibn Kathir that no doubt may be left for the People of the Scripture and the believers, and that those in whose hearts is a disease and the disbelievers may say: “What does Allah intend by this example?” Thus Allah leads astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills. And none can know the hosts of your Lord but He. And this is nothing but a reminder to mankind.} 432. Nay! And by the moon.} <33. And by the night when it withdraws.} 434. And by the dawn when it brightens.} 435. Verily, it is but one of the greatest (signs).} 436. A warning to mankind} <37. To any of you that chooses to go forward, or to remain behind.} The Number of Guardians of Hell and what the Disbelievers said about that Allah says, 4P J^A ££. 4And We have set none as (Ashab) guardians of the Fire} meaning, its guardians. <‘SiL; •}} 4but angels.} Guardian angels, stem and severe. This is a refutation of the idolaters of the Quraysh when they mentioned the number of guardian angels. Abu Jahl said, “O people of Quraysh! Are not every ten among you able to defeat one of them?” So Allah said, <k£ P^A ILr 4And We have set none but angels as guardians of the Fire.} meaning, extremely strong in their creation. They cannot be stood against nor defeated. It has been said that Abu Al- Ashaddayn, and his name was Kaladah bin Usayd bin Khalaf, said, “O people of Quraysh! You defend me against two of them and I will defend you against seventeen of them.” He said this thinking himself to be very great. For they claimed that he achieved such strength that he would stand on a skin

of cow hide and ten people would try to pull it out from under his feet, but the skin would be torn to pieces and still not be removed from under him. Concerning Allah’s statement, c4i & } y <&r £>) 4And We have fixed their number only as a trial for the disbelievers,) meaning, “We only have mentioned their number as being nineteen as a test from Us for mankind.’ of iln order that the People of the Scripture may arrive at a certainty meaning, so that they may know that this Messenger is true. For he speaks according to the same thing that they have with them of heavenly revealed Scriptures that came to the Prophets before him. Concerning Allah’s statement, ik\ ££ of &>> iand that the believers may increase in faith . meaning, to their faith. This is due to what they witness from the truthfulness of the information of their Prophet, Muhammad jg. 4 \?jt off ^s) iand that no doubt may be left for the People of the Scripture and the believers, and that those in whose hearts is a disease) meaning, among the hypocrites. iand the disbelievers may say: “What does Allah intend by this example?”) meaning, they say, “What is the wisdom in mentioning this here?” Allah says, iThus Allah leads astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills.)

meaning, by way of examples like this, faith becomes firm in the hearts of some people and it is shaken with others. This has a profound wisdom and it is an irrefutable proof. None knows the Soldiers of Allah except Him Allah says, 4And none can know the hosts of your Lord but He. meaning, none knows their number and their count except Allah. This is so that one does not make the mistake of thinking that they are only nineteen in all. It has been confirmed in the Hadith concerning AMsrd that is reported in the Two Sahihs and other collections, that the Messenger of Allah said in describing the Frequent House (Al-Bayt Al- Ma’mur), which is in the seventh heaven, tp 4]Ip U ji- *11} jj’iyu V Jlii Jij! jjaL^ . 1Seventy thousand angels enter into it every day and they do not return to it as it is all that is due upon them (one visit in their lifetime).^ Concerning Allah’s statement, 4M.& i ji c;} 4And this is nothing but a reminder to mankind.} Mujahid and others said, is, 4And this is not.} “This means the Hellfire which has been described.”131 4but a reminder to mankind.} Then Allah says, *** The Prophet’s Night

Journey to Jerusalem and then into the heavens I2 * Fath Al-Bari 6 :348 , and Muslim 1 :146 At-Tabari 24 :32

rijj wSSRifig OVV / > "If ^ *44 Lj Qrv«V .tJ 1 •***' a , y^ ^ i J -V-r:Jifey ^5 J*1ji!\$ oW\ojjSjbUj pt JM mWMI% ^ 4N«i// And by the moon. And by the night when it withdraws.} meaning, when it withdraws. i 7'.>d 5}^} iAnd by the dawn when it brightens.\$ meaning, when it shines. i%p> Q\} iVerily, it is but one of the greatest (signs).} meaning, the great things. This refers to the Hellfire. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and others of the Salaf, all said this. 11 ' j £. fc jj "ifM i&'A i r-^ . 4A warning to mankind - to any ofyou that chooses to goforward, or to remain behind.} meaning, for whoever wishes to accept the warning and be guided to the truth, or hold back from accepting it, turn away from it and reject it. 1*< *V? y->- 4 . 7>Oyf fSeA Sj ,TK,ioJyj Coif Uj jf} *-* . 11 .IrSCL-J' oil dj oi 4L 3 'j)U . tT , j lj > .~t0***r"" ,mjCI Li L.l.l tV . 1 -*y~i , l5 . i-1 K5j-f Jf Oof jj .Q/fJ)-* Ji *o> i*J}ji£ZZ "jLy <>*** ft? (fe OJjiLfc V S. 'tjiyVfiji U»w* iJi o' 4f)y J*!> csj& J»1 j* <i' ;Ua o' Vj offJu Uj :.»7do^='* iti •AodrldeO^ll aJo {JpoJjil" III At-Tabari 24 :33

438. Every person is a pledgefor what he has earned,4 439. Except those on the Right. 440. In Gardens they will ask one another, 441 . About criminals (and they will say to them) :4 442. "Wltat has caused you to enter Hell?"4 443. They will say: "We were not of those who used to offer the Salah,"4 444. "Nor did wefeed the poor;"4 445. "And we used to speakfalsewod with vain speakers."4 446. "And we used to deny the Day ofRecompense,"4 447. "Until Al-Yaqin came to us."4 448. So no intercession of intercessors will be of any use to them. 449. Then what is wrong with them that they turn away from admonition?4 450. As if they were wild donkeys . 451. Fleeingfrom a Qasioarah.4 452. Nay, everyone of them desires that he should be give pages spread out. 453. Nay! But theyfear not the Hereafter. 454. Nay, verily, this is an admonition. 455. So, whosoever wills receives admonitionfrom it!4 456. And they will not receive admonition unless Allah wills; He is the One, deserving of the Taqwd and He is the One Wlw forgives . What will take place in the Discussion between the People ofParadise and the People ofthe Hellfire Allah informs that, 4Every person is a pledgefor what he has earned,4 meaning, bound to his deed on the Day of Judgement. Ibn 'Abbas and others have said this. 111 At-Jabari 24:35.

4Except those on the Right.} For verily, they will be 4V.jv f- 44 4In Gardens they will ask one another, about criminals (and they will say to them)} meaning, while they are in lofty rooms they will ask the criminals, who will be in the lowest levels (of Hell), saying to them, 4"What has caused you to enter Hell?" They will say: "We were not of those who used to offer the Salah, nor did we feed the poor.}" meaning, "we did not worship Allah, nor did we do good to His creatures of our own species (i.e., other people).' £ <j*y 4And we used to speakfalsehood with vain speakers.} meaning, "we used to speak about what we had no knowledge of.' Qatadah said, "It means that eveiy time someone went astray we would go astray with them." 4;>v,i£>0 f fk. 4And we used to deny the Day of Recompense, until the certainty (Al-Yaqin) came to us.} meaning, death. This is as Allah says, 43VCvifiJ' liOij >} 4And worship your Lord until there comes unto you the certainty.} (15:99) The Messenger of Allah gj said, ^jA (JjaIsA jU.fr c~*-j bl® ^Concerning him verily, Al-Yaqin (death) came to him from 111 At-Jabari 24:37. Meaning Tithman bin Maz*Qn

258 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr his Lord. i)"1 11 Allah then says, iSo no intercession of intercessors will be ofany use to them .^ meaning, whoever has these characteristics, then the intercession of whoever tries to

intercede for him will be of no benefit on the Day of Judgement. This is because intercession is only useful if the conditions for it are met. However, whoever comes before Allah as a disbeliever on the Day of Judgement, then he will get the Hellfire and there is no way of avoiding it. He will abide in it (Hell) forever. The Disapproval of the Disbelievers' Rejection and Their Position Then Allah says, *What is wrong with them that they turn away from admonition?* meaning, "what is wrong with these disbelievers who are turning away from what you are calling them to and reminding them of?" 4As if they were wild donkeys. Fleeing from a Qaswarah meaning, as if they were fleeing from the truth and turning away from it, like a wild donkey when it flees from something that is trying to catch it, like a lion. This was said by Abu Hurayrah.¹²¹ Hammad bin Salamah reported from 'Ali bin Zayd who reported from YQsuf bin Mihran who narrated that Ibn 'Abbas said, "It (Qaswarah) is the lion in the Arabic language. It is called Qaswarah in the Abyssinian language, Sher in the Persian language and Awba in the Nabtiyyah (Nabatean) language."¹³ Al-Bayhaqi 3 :406. '2 ' At-Jabari 24 :42 131 At-Tabari 24:42.

Concerning Allah's statement, *And everyone of them desires that he should be given pages spread out.* meaning, each one of these idolators wants to have a book revealed to him as Allah revealed to the Prophet jfe. Mujahid and others have said this. This is similar to Allah's statement, *And when there comes to them a sign they say: "We shall not believe until we receive the like of that which the Messengers of Allah had received."* Allah knows best with whom to place His Message .} (6:124) It is reported in a narration from Qatadah that he said, "They want to be declared innocent (on the Day of Judgement) without having to do any deeds."¹²¹ Then Allah says. 4Nay! But they fear not the Hereafter.} meaning, they were only corrupted by their lack of faith in it and their rejection of its occurrence. The Qur'an is a Reminder Then Allah says, 4Nay, verily, this is an admonition.} meaning, truly the Qur'an is a reminder. d% ojfe Cj tLS^} 4So, whosoever wills receives admonition (from it)! And they will not receive admonition unless Allah wills;} This is similar to Allah's statement, [11 Al-Qurtubi 19:90. At-Tabari 24:43.

<fAnd t/OM cannot will unless Allah wills.} (81:29) Concerning Allah's statement, *He is the One, deserving the Tacpva and He is the One Who forgives.* This means that He deserves to be feared and He is eligible to forgive the sin of whoever turns to Him and repents. This was said by Qatadah.

Surah 75: Al-Qiyamah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6207–6228]

Opening 263 Surah 75. Al-Qiyamah (1-15) (Part-29) Allah said; 4Does man think that We shall not assemble his bones?} meaning, ‘on the Day of Judgement does he think that We are not able to return his bones and gather them from their various places?’ J iif 4Yes, We are able to put together in perfect order the tips of his fingers.} meaning, ‘does man think that We will not gather his bones? Surely, We will gather them and We are quite able to put together his fingertips. This means Our power is suitable to gather (and recreate) them, and if We wished We could surely resurrect him with more than what he originally had. We could make his fingers, which are the tips of his fingers, all equal (in length).’ Concerning Allah’s statement, +4& iNay! Man desires to break out ahead of himself.} Said reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “This means to proceed forward.” Mujahid said about, ito break out ahead of himself.} “This means that he wants to proceed ahead following his own whims.” ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “This refers to the disbeliever who denies the Day of Reckoning.” Ibn Zayd said the same thing. Thus, Allah says after this, fk Js-4^ 4He asks: “When will be this Day of Resurrection?”} meaning, he says when will the Day of Judgement be? His question is only a question of denying its occurrence, and 111 At-Tabari 24:54. At-Jabari 24:54.

rejecting its existence. This is as Allah says, V jCS fj js ?*lczjx£> y-£L-< 4 ‘ill 4 they say: “When is this promise if you are truthful?” Say : “The appointment to you is for a Day, which you cannot put back for an Iwur nor put forward.”} (34:29-30) Here Allah says, 4So, when Bariqa the sight.} Abu ‘Amr bin Al-‘Ala’ recited this Ayah as Bariqa with a Kasrah under the letter J?d,m which means to be diminished. That which he (Abu ‘Amr) has said resembles the statement of Allah, iTheir gaze returning not towards them.} (14:43) meaning, they will be looking this way and that way in horror. Their gaze will not be able to rest upon anything due to the severity of the terror on that Day. Others recited it as Baraqa with a Fathah over the letter Ra, and its meaning is close to the first recitation (Bariqa). The intent here is that the eyes will be dazzled, humbled, diminished, and humiliated on the Day of Judgement due to the severity of the horrors and the greatness of the matters that they will witness on that Day. Concerning Allah’s statement, 4And the moon will be eclipsed.} meaning, its light will go away. 4And the sun and moon will be joined together.} Mujahid said, “They will be rolled up.”^ In explaining this Ayah, Ibn Zayd recited the following Ayat, *** As is known from the recitation of Hafs. 121 At-Jabari 24:57.

266 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Deeds of Man will be placed before Him on the Day of Judgement Then Allah says, ^ i±ts. iOti that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind.} meaning, he will be informed of all of his deeds, the old of them and the recent of them, the first of

them and the last of them, the small of them and the large of them. This is as Allah says, *itL iJL* U* iAnd they will find all that they did, placed before them, and your Lord treats no one with injustice.} (18:49) Likewise, Allah says here, }Nay! Man will be well informed about himself, though he may putforth his excuses.} meaning, he will be a witness against himself, knowing full well what he did, even though he will try to make excuses and deny it. This is as Allah says, 4®^ 4(11 will be said to him): "Read your book. You are sufficient as a reckoner against yourself this Day."} 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, 4Nay! Man will be well informed about himself.} "His hearing, his sight, his two hands, his two legs and his limbs."* 11 Qatadah said, This means he is a witness against himself." In another narration from Qatadah he said, "By Allah! If you wish to see him, you would see him as someone who sees the shortcomings of the people and their sins, yet he is heedless of PI At-Tabari 24 :62

267Surah 75. Al-Oiudmah (1-15) (Part-29) his own sins." It used to be said, "Verily, it is written in the Injil: 'O Son of Adam, do you see the small splinters in the eye of your brother and disregard the tree stump that is in your eye, so you do not see it?' Mujahid said, \$ to {Though he may put forth his excuses .} "This means, even though he argues in defense of it, he is a witness against it." Qatadah said, <S«£*&& {Though he may put forth his excuses.} "Even though he will try to make false excuses on that Day, they will not be accepted from him."12 * As-Suddi said, «i>»\$ to ^Though he may put forth his excuses.} "This means his argument." This is as Allah says. i & C%& i>' J ^ J2 3 to {There will then be no Fitnah for them but to say: "By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah."} (6:23) Allah also says, r\ ^ tCA CT \Lr- ifll ^*7 fji} >> 40n the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you (O Muslims). And they think that they have something. Verily, they are liars!} (58:18) Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas: \$ to 111 At-Tabari 24:64. 121 At-Tabari 24:65. Excuses , statements or arguments

268 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iThough he may putforth his excuses.} "This is apologizing. Haven't you heard that Allah said, ip;*: £ i} iThe Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers .} (40:52) and He says, w'k& JI iAnd they will offer submission to Allah on that Day.} (16:87) and He says, 4ft-' Jt S*- * '\$&} iThen they will (falsely) submit: "We used not to do any evil."} (16:28) and their statement, 4By Allah, our Lord, we were not those who joined others in worship with Allah.} (6:23) "< 11 roj f \$ Hi* fcx ££ jw. . C\$> oil rifi fry »a jf i iCi 426. Mooe not yowr tongue concerning to make haste therewith.} 417. It is for Us to collect it and that it be recited.} 418. And when We have recited it to you, then follow its recitation .} 419. Then it isfor Us to make it clear.} 420. But no! Rather you love the present life of this world,} 421. And neglect the Hereafter.} 422. Somefaces that Day shall be Nadirdh.} 423. Looking at their Lord.} Ul At-Jabari 24 :64

270 Tafslr Ibn Kathir he taughtyou to recite it.' k ft iTheti it is for Us to make it clear.} meaning, 'after memorizing it and reciting it, We will explain it to you, clarify it and inspire you with its meaning according to what We intended and legislated.' Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said that the Messenger of Allah jg used to struggle very hard to grasp the revelation and he used to move his lips (rapidly with the recitation). The narrator, Said, then said, "Ibn 'Abbas said to me, 1 will move my lips like the Messenger of Allah used to move his lips (in order to show you).' " Then, the subnarrator said, "And Said said to me, "I will move my lips like I saw Ibn 'Abbas moving his lips (in order to

show you).’ ” Then Allah revealed, ^ 'i} iMove not your tongue concerning to make haste therewith. It is for Us to collect it and tlm it be recited.} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means He will collect it in his chest to recite it. iAnd when We have recited it to you, then follow its recitation.} meaning, listen to it and pay attention. & k ft iThen it is for Us to make it clear (to you).} So after this, when Jibril would leave, he would recite it as Jibril had taught him to recite it.”¹¹¹ This has also been recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Al- Bukhari’s wording says, “So whenever Jibril would come to him he would be silent, and when Jibril had left he would recite it just as Allah, the Mighty and Sublime had promised him.”^{*2’} 1,1 Ahmad 1:343. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 :39, 8:547, 549, 550, 707, and 13:508, and Muslim

272 Surah 75. Al-Oiyamah (16-25) (Part-29) The Cause of rejecting the Day of Judgement is Love of the World and Heedlessness of the Hereafter Concerning Allah’s statement, iBut no! Rather you love the present life of this world. And neglect the Hereafter.} meaning, the only thing that has caused them to reject the Day of Judgement and oppose the true revelation and the Mighty Qur’an Allah revealed to His Messenger jg is that their only concern is the present worldly life. They are preoccupied and distracted from the Hereafter. Seeing Allah in the Hereafter Then Allah says, iSome faces that Day shall be Nadirah.} which comes from the word Nadarah, which means splendid, radiant, glowing, delighted with goodness. iLooking at their Lord.} meaning, they will see Him with their very eyes. This is just as was recorded by Al-Bukhari in his Sahih, •ft* byfz. fill 1 Verily you all will see your Lord with your own eyes.^ The believers seeing Allah in the abode of the Hereafter has been confirmed in the authentic Hadiths from numerous routes of transmission with the scholars of Hadith. It is not possible to deny this or refuse it. Examples would be the Hadiths of Abu Said and Abu Hurayrah, and they are both recorded in the Two Sahih. They both mentioned that some people said, “O Messenger of Allah! Will we see our Lord on the Day of Judgement?” The Prophet jg said. m Path Al-Bdri 13:430.

272 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ii}j J> djLi: J “Are yoM harmed by seeing the sun and the moon when there are no clouds beneath them? They replied, “No.” The Prophet jg then said, 9<IUi5 Ojj “Then you will surely see your Lord like that .»(1 In the Two Sahths it is recorded from Jabir that he said, “The Messenger of Allah sg looked at the moon on a night when it was full, and he said, jj vk* Jj. \)&iM pa^i jji ili by) us jjzi by) ,yy} j) ij tJL « Verily , you will see your Lord just as you see this moon! So if you are able to avoid missing a prayer before the rising of the sun (Fajr prayer) or before its setting (‘Asr prayer) then do 50 d’K2| Among the Hadiths, which Muslim was alone in recording, is a narration from Suhayb that the Prophet said, UJ» OjJjJj ! ~~ Jit — 4l>Jl 0»Jl ^3 3^“^ b|® diSSS : Jit ^ S4J1 dUx pi ? likyr’j 34: pi :b)Jd J\ ylaJl bf j»4l ‘Lsi-l Uli l^kii Ui iWhen the people of Paradise enter the Paradise, Allah will say, ‘Do you want me to give you anything extra?’ They will say, ‘Haven't you whitened our faces? Haven’t you entered us into Paradise and saved ms from the Fire?’ Then He will remove the veil and they will not be given anything more beloved to them than looking at their Lord, and that will be the extra (Ziyadah).» Then he recited this Ayah, £2UB *** FathAl-Bari 13:430, 431 and Muslim 1 : 163,162. FathAl-Bari 13:429, and Muslim 1 :439.

273 Surah 75. Al-Oiudmah (16-25) (Part-29) 4For those who have done good is the best and extra (Ziyddah).} (10:26)m Also among the Hadiths, which Muslim was alone in recording, is the Hadith of Jabir in which the Prophet jg said, 3>i jl» « Verily, Allah will appear before the believers while He is laughing .»^{*21} This will take place on the open plains of the Resurrection place. In some of these

Hadiths, it mentions that the believers will be looking at their Lord on the open plains and some mention that this will occur in the Gardens of Paradise. If it were not due to fear of taking up a lot of space, we would present all of these Hadiths with their routes of transmission and wordings from those that are in the Sahih collections, the collections of good narrations, the Musnad collections and the Sunan collections. However, we have mentioned this in separate places in this Tafsir, and Allah is the Giver of success. This issue is something that the Companions, the Successors and the Salaf of this nation have agreed upon, and all praise is due to Allah. It is something that is agreed upon between the Imams of Islam and the guides of all mankind. Blackening of the Faces of the Disobedient People on the Day of Judgement Allah says, 4TO 0 4And some faces that Day will be Bdsirah. Thinking that some calamity is about to fall on them These are the faces of the sinners that will be Bdsirah on the Day of Judgement. Qatadah said, "This means gloomy. "3 ' As- Suddi said, "Their (the faces) color will change."141 (1) Muslim 1 :163. 121 Muslim 1:178. At-Jabari 24:74. 4| Al-Qurtubi 19:110.

274 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4Thinking^ meaning, they will be certain. 4that some calamity is about to fall on them .) Mujahid said, "A disaster."111 Qatadah said, "An evil." As- Suddi said, "They will be certain that they are going to be destroyed." Ibn Zayd said, "They will think that they are going to enter into the Hellfire." This situation is similar to Allah's statement, &>> "w w fjir 4On the Day when somefaces will become white and somefaces will become black.} (3:106) Similarly Allah says, (&}@ <& itk tjtio 4Somefaces that Day will be bright. Laughing, rejoicing at the good news. And other faces, that Day will be dust-stained; darkness will cover them, such will be the disbelieving, wicked.} (80:38-42) Allah also says, i 4^ 4Some faces, that Day will be humiliated. Laboring, weary. They will enter in the hot blazing Fire.} (88:2-4) until Allah says, 4(Other) faces that Day will be joyful. Happy with their endeavor. In a lofty Paradise.} (88:8-10) And there are other similar Ayat and discussions (in the Qur'an). Ill At-Tabari 24:74.

' gasses 0VA mmm gp Vj j£ jj ;tq£)1 j&i •&' iii \$ ^oO" d!& 'f w&>& Si (\$) <12 J\$ i^;j^i ^\$\$ <* 4}t ? ^iS^gaaa^sg^ *****&*•« >' &Jji&J\$^i^&fo0&>!>! 52 26 'f 5 " "4 ^ hs^ttotst^sb »«**»*< Cr* j^j J3./ iji<'J* 6' ^^ ; .it. KawaastH^ -^Basawgaa < < v .-< ^ : .{.T ,f. ,, ...? .v -? . r f4 ".siU'MUu ^26 - NflJ/' «*«* It rea- LaL.^ dies to the collarbones.} Q'tjffifrf£\Z\Z)\^&MIQ&^ <27 - And U wil1 be "S'ryti " ^ .!<r;V-.1t?. Sfl"* : m° ran cwre him?"} d) 42S. And he uri/J think ^ ' ' that it was the parting;} 429. And one shank will be joined with another shank.} 430. The drive will be on that Day to your Lord!} So, he neither believed nor prayed!} 432 . But on the contrary, he denied and turned away!} 433 . Then he walked in conceit to his family admiring himself.} 434. \Noe to you! And then woe to you!} 435. Again, woe to you! And then woe to you!} 436. Does man think that he will be left neglected?} 437. Was he not a Nutfah ofsemen emitted?} 438. Then he became an 'Alaqah; then shaped andfashioned in due proportion .} 439. And made ofhim two sexes, male andfemale.}

276 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 440. Is it not so then, that He would be able to give life to the dead?) Certainty will occur at the Time ofDeath Allah informs of the condition at the time of death and what terrors it contains. May Allah make us firm at that time with the Firm Statement. Allah says, 4Nay, when it reaches to the collarbones.) If we make the word "Kalla." negative, then this Ayah means, 'O son of Adam! You are not able to deny that which I informed you of at that time (death). This will become something witnessed by you with your own eyes.' If we consider the word "Kalla." to be a word of

affirmation, then this would be the most obvious meaning. In this case it would mean that it is certainly true when the soul reaches the collarbones - meaning, your soul will be pulled out of your body and it will reach your collarbones.' This is similar to Allah's statement, 4Then why do you not (intervene) when (the soul of the dying person) reaches the throat? And you at the moment are looking on, but We are nearer to him than you, but you see not, then why do you not if you are exempt from the reckoning and recompense, bring back the soul, if you are truthful?) (56:83-87) Thus, Allah similarly says here, S 0* ui it) 4Nay, when it reaches to the collarbones. And it will be said: "Who can cure him?) 'Ikrimah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Meaning, who is the person who recites divine prayers of healing so that he may come and cure him?"* 11 Abu Qilabah made a similar statement when he said, (i| At-Tabari 24:75.

Jt I* ipueS^ iSo worship what you like besides Him.) (39:15) And like Allah's statement, 4£L C \p\)\$Do what you will.) (41:40) There are other examples of this as well. Abu 'Abdur-Rahman An-Nasal recorded from Said bin Jubayr that he said, "I mentioned to Ibn 'Abbas, in dj! f Jiu iWoe to you! And then woe to you! Again, woe to you! And then woe to you!) He (Ibn 'Abbas) replied, The Messenger of Allah said this to Abu Jahl, then Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, revealed this Ayah.' "111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Qatadah that he said concerning Allah's statement, iu dj! ? Jtf dj1> iWoe to you! And then woe to you! Again, woe to you! And then woe to you!) "It is a threat followed by a threat, just as you hear it. They claim that the Prophet of Allah grabbed the clothes of the enemy of Allah, Abu Jahl. The Prophet \$>£3 then said to him, *Woe to you! And then (again) woe to you! Again woe to you! And then (again) woe to you!' At this the enemy of Allah, Abu Jahl, said, 'Are you threatening me, O Muhammad? By Allah! Neither you nor your Lord are able to do anything, and verily, I am the mightiest person walking between its (Makkah's) two mountains.' "21 Man will not be left neglected Allah says, An-NasST in Al-Kubrd 6 :504 ^ This is a Mursal narration, but its previous narration meaning is supported by the

iDoes man think that he will be left neglected?} As-Suddi said, "Meaning not resurrected." Mujahid, Ash-Shafil and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, all said, "Meaning, he will not be commanded and prohibited." Apparently the Ayah includes both meanings. This means that he will not be left neglected in this worldly life, without being commanded and prohibited. He also will not be left neglected in his grave unattended to without being resurrected. Rather he will be commanded and prohibited in this life, and gathered back to Allah in the abode of the Hereafter. The intent here is to affirm the existence of the abode of the final return and to refute whoever rejects it from the people of deviance, ignorance and stubbornness. Thus, Allah uses the beginning of creation as a proof for the repetition of the creation in His saying, Jjr he not a Nutfah of semen emitted?} meaning, was not man a weak drop of sperm from a despised fluid known as semen, that is emitted from the loins into the wombs? AThen he became an 'Alaqah; then shaped and fashioned in due proportion .} meaning, he became a clot, then a lump of flesh, then he was formed and the soul was blown into him. Then he became a perfect creation with healthy limbs, as either a male or a female by the permission and decree of Allah. Thus, Allah says, 3i> AAnd made of him two sexes, male and female. Then Allah says, uA J# iA AIs it not so then, that He would be able to give life to the dead?} meaning, is not He Who made this perfect creation from this weak drop of sperm able to repeat that as He did originally?

282 Tafsir Ibn Kathir And "the ability to repeat that" either refers to the origination only, or to both that and the process of perfecting it, according to two different views, as in Allah's saying; /t // > "•• 'l' It \K .If f jVUJ' 'j-O y^Jr iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; this is easier for Hint.} (30:27) The first view is more popular, and Allah knows best. Supplication upon completing this Surah Abu Dawud recorded from Musa bin Abi 'A'ishah that he said, "A man used to pray on top of his house and whenever he recited, • ils it not so then, that He would be able to give life to the dead?} he would say, 'Glory to You, of course.' So the people asked him about that and he said, 'I heard it from the Messenger of Allah si.' "11 Abu Dawud was alone in transmitting this Hadlth and he did not mention who this Companion was, but there is no harm in that.

Surah 76: Al-Insan

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6229]

Opening The Tafstrof SuratAl-Insan (Chapter - 76)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6229–6241]

The Recitation of SuratAs-Sctfdah and Al-Insan in the Morning Prayer on Friday It has been mentioned previously that it is recorded in Sahih Muslim from Ibn ‘Abbas that the Messenger of Allah jg used to recite in the Morning prayer on Friday: iAlifLam Mtm. The revelation.. .^(32) and; iHas there not been over matt...} (76) [2 In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ££ % jfi] 11 . Has there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth mentioning?} 12. Verily, We have created man from Nutfah Amshdj, in order to try him, so, We made him hearer and seer 13. Verily, We guided him to the way, whether he be grateful or ungrateful Allah created Man after He did not exist Allah informs that He brought man into existence after he was I 1 ' This Surah is also known as Surat Ad-Dahr. 121 Muslim 2 :599

284 Tafstr Ibn Kathir not even a thing worth mentioning, due to his lowliness and weakness. Allah says, iHas there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth mentioning?) Then Allah explains this by saying, iliS j iVerily, We have created manfrom Nutfah Amshaj,) meaning, mixed. The words Mashaj and Mashij mean something that is mixed together. Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning Allah’s statement, iiti #) ifrom Nutfah Amshaj,) “This means the fluid of the man and the fluid of the woman when they meet and mix.” Then man changes after this from stage to stage, condition to condition and color to color. Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Ar-RabT bin Anas all made statements similar to this. They said, “Amshaj is the mixing of the man’s fluid with the woman’s fluid.”12, Concerning Allah’s statement, iin order to try him,) means, *‘We test him.’ It is similar to Allah’s statement, p] p*‘£l) iThat He may test you which ofyou is best in deed.) (67:2) Then Allah says, iso, We made him hearer and seer.) meaning, We gave him the faculties of hearing and sight so that he would be able ,to use them for obedience and disobedience.’ 111 At-Tabari 24:89. At-Tabari 24:89,90.

Allah guidedHim to the Path, so Man is either Grateful or Ungrateful Allah says, 4X£jI& q} iVerily, We guided to him the way,} meaning, We explained it to him, made it clear to him and showed it to him.’ This is as Allah says, J i .f- 4And as for Thamud, I’ve guided them but they preferred blindness to guidance.} (41:17) Allah also said, 4And We guided him to the two ways.} (90:10) meaning, We explained to him the path of good and the path of evil.’ This is the statement of Ikrimah, ‘Atiyah, Ibn

Zayd and Mujahid from what is well-known from him and the majority. Allah then says, 406&% (fe ^Whether he be grateful or ungrateful.) This is his decree. Thus, with this he is either wretched or happy. This is like what has been recorded by Muslim in a Hadith from Abu Malik Al-Ash'ari. He said that the Messenger of Allah jgg said, # , I , i ^ 9 p+ p *r ^ * pi j tP *1 jl i kZJli jJo ^Ul *All of mankind wakes up in the morning the merchant of his own soul. So he either imprisons it or sets it free. bi'I v&Ss sr J? Jt '\$a ;<>Vf i[Mi sul £A\$ t*j> o/Wj 'Q-XP r^i <i(it? l ^ 2Ch Qp &4 *&&&£ Ql ££ *£= tIS lijle Cj> fcj j* «jU El Vj HI Muslim 1 :203

JLfr^f " [>/' \s > ***• "J ,, »y •>> - 44. Verily, We have prepared for the disbelievers iron chains, iron collars, and Sa'ir.} 45. Verily, the Abrdr (righteous believers) shall drink of a cup mixed with Kafir.} 46. A spring wherefrom the servants of Allah will drink, causing it to gush forth abundantly.} 47. They fulfill (their) vows, and they fear a Day whose evil will be wide-spreading.} 48 . And they give food, in spite of their love for it, to the poor, the orphan and the captive,} 49. (Saying) : "We feed you seeking Allah's Face only. We wish for no reward, nor thanks from you."} 410. "Verily, We fear from our Lord a Day that is 'Abus and Qamtar Tr."} 411 . So, Allah saved them from the evil of that Day, and gave them Nadrah (a light of beauty) and joy.} 412. And their recompense shall be Paradise, and silken garments, because they were patient.} The Recompense of the Disbelievers and the Righteous Allah informs of what he has waiting for those who disbelieve in Him from His creatures of chains, iron collars and Sa'ir. Sa'ir is the flame and fire of the Hell. This is as Allah says, 4 jL 4When iron collars will be rounded over their necks, and the chains, they shall be dragged along, in the boiling water, then they will be burned in the Fire.} (40:71,72) After mentioning the blazing Fire He has prepared for these wretched people, Allah goes on to say. 4 - fr. & ofr" at ojCA Jjn 4Verily, the Abrar (righteous believers) shall drink of a cup mixed with Kafir.} The properties of the Kafir (camphor) are well known; cooling,

having a nice fragrance and in addition to this its taste will be delicious in Paradise. Al-Hasan said, "The coolness of the camphor will be in the pleasantness of ginger." Thus Allah said, 4A spring wherefrom the servants of Allah will drink, causing it to gush forth abundantly.} meaning, this (drink) that will be mixed for these righteous people will be taken from Kafur, which is a spring that Allah's close servants will drink directly from, without it being mixed with anything, and they will drink to their fill from it. The word Yashrabu (to drink) includes the meaning of Yarwa (to quench one's thirst). Allah then says, 4 (fry 4causing it to gush forth abundantly (Tajjir).} meaning, they will have control of it however and wherever they wish. They will have access to it from their castles, their homes, their sitting rooms and their residences. At-Tafjir means to cause to gush forth or flow out. This is as Allah says, >V .I,*? " is ^ *4 ' *>Ss\ 4And they say: "We shall not believe in you until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us.} (17:90) And Allah says, 4We caused a river to gush forth in the midst of them.} (18:33) Mujahid said, it causing it to gush forth abundantly.} "This means that they will divert it to wherever they wish." Ikrimah and Qatadah both made similar statements.121 Ath-Thawri said, "They will cause it to flow wherever they wish."*31 At-Tabari 24:94. 121 Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8 : 369 (3 > At-Tabari 24:95.

The Deeds of these Righteous People Allah says, i(£ yr M& }They fulfill vows, and they fear a Day whose evil will be wide- spreading.} meaning, they devote to worship Allah using that which He made obligatory upon them from actions of obligatory obedience that is based on Islamic legislation. They

also worship Him by fulfilling their vows. Imam Malik reported from Talhah bin ‘Abdul-Malik Al-Ayli, who reported from Al-Qasim bin Malik, from ‘A’ishah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *ji j«b iAuld) <i>l jl j-k ^Whoever makes a vow to obey Allah, then he should obey Him. And whoever makes a vow to disobey Allah, then he should not disobey Him .**111 Al-Bukhari also recorded this Hadith from Malik . These people also abandon those forbidden things which He (Allah) has prohibited for them, due to their fear of having an evil reckoning on the Day of Return. This is the Day when the evil will spread outamong all people except for those uponwhom Allah has had mercy. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Spreading.”Qatadah said, “By Allah! The evil ofthat Day will spread until it fills the heavens and the earth.”131 Concerning Allah’s statement, *4•.*!>- iAnd they givefood, inspite of their lovefor it,}* It has been said that this means the love of Allah, the Most High. In their view the pronoun refers to Allah. However, the most apparent meaning is that the pronoun refers to the food. This would mean, they give food while they themselves love it and desire it. This was stated by Mujahid and Muqatil, and it was the preferred opinion of Ibn Jarir. 141 This is similar to Muwatta’2 :476. 121 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :589 ,3) At-Tabari 24:96. 141 At-Tabari 24:96.

289Surah 76. Al-Insan (4-12) (Part-29) Allah’s statement. *<3df ji;> iAnd gives his wealth, in spite oflovefor it.}* (2:177) Allah also says, */s>>. > > <1 U- < / i / V jji' i*ajib: *iBy no means shall you attain Al-Birr^ unless you spend of that which you love.}* (3:92) In the Sahih, there is a Hadith which states, *OjIj jj-ij ut SiJukJl “The fees! charity is that which you give while you are healthy, covetous, hopingfor wealth andfearing poverty. »**2 This means in the condition of your love for wealth, your eagerness for it and your need for it. Thus, Allah says, *iAnd they givefood, inspite of their lovefor it, to the poor, the orphan and the captive,}* Concerning the poor person and the orphan, an explanation of them and their characteristics has already preceded.*3 * In reference to the captive, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan and Ad-Dahhak all said, “He is the captive among the people of the Qiblah (i.e., the Muslims).”*4 Ibn ‘Abbas said, “At that time (when this Ayah was revealed) their (the Muslims’) captives were idolaters.”*5 * Proof for this is that on the day of Badr the Messenger of Allah ﷺ commanded his Companions to treat the captives respectfully. They (the Companions) would give them preference over themselves when eating their meals. ‘Ikrimah said, “They (captives) are the slaves.”*6 * Ibn Jarir preferred this See volume two, the Tafsirof Surah At ‘Imran (3 :92). '2| Fath Al-Bari 3 :334 * See volume one, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah (2:177) and volume four, the Tafsirof SiimtAt-Tawbah (9 :60) ' At-Jabari 24:97. ‘Abdur-Razzaq 3:337. *6) Al-Qurfubi 19:129.

opinion since the Ayah generally refers to both the Muslim and the idolaters. ' Said bin Jubayr, ‘Ata’, Al-Hasan and Qatadah all made similar statements. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ advised treating servants well in more than one Hadith. This held such importance with him that the last statement of advice that he gave (before dying) was his saying, *«77ie prayer (As-Saldh) and what your right hand possesses (slaves). «*'2' Mujahid said, “He (the captive) is the prisoner.”13 ' This means that these (righteous) people give food to others even though they themselves desire it and love it, saying at the same time, *4j*f fLL 4Wefeed you seeking Allah's Face only\$ meaning, hoping for the reward of Allah and His pleasure. %&&% 4We wish for no reward, nor thanksfrom you.\$ meaning, “we do not seek any reward from you in return for it. We also are not seeking for you to thank us in front of the people.’* Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr both said, “By Allah! They do not say this with their tongues, but rather, Allah knows it in their hearts and He commends them for it. Every seeker should seek after this.”*4'

4'Jii'iy^ ki ot -->£ iVerily, We fear from our Lord a Day that is 'Abus and Qamtarir.} meaning, "we only do this so that perhaps Allah may have mercy on us and treat us with gentleness on the Day that is 'Abus and Qamtarir.' 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn At-Tabari 24:98. * An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 4 :258 At-Jabari 24:98. ' At-Jabari 24:98.

291Surah 76. Al-Insan (4-12) (Part-29) 'Abbas, "'Abus means difficult and Qamtarir means long.'"! 'Ikrimah and others said from Ibn Abbas, 4a Day that is 'Abus and Qamtarir (hard and distressful, that will make the faces look horrible from extreme dislike to it.)) "The disbeliever will frown on that day until sweat will flow between his eyes like tar."12 ' Mujahid said, "Abus 'Abis means (frowning with) the two lips and Qamtarir means drawing up the face in a scowl." Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said, "Faces will be made to frown due to dismay. Qamtarir is the contraction of the forehead and what is between the two eyes due to dismay." Ibn Zayd said, " 'Abus is the evil and Qamtarir is the severity." Some Details concerning the Reward of the Righteous in Paradise and what it contains of Delights Allah says, 4So, Allah saved them from the evil of that Day, and gave them Nadrah (a light of beauty) and joy.} This is used as a way of eloquence in stating similarity (i.e., two similar things). vii'i 'f. iai foj} 4So, Allah saved them from the evil of that Day,} meaning, He protects them from that which they fear of it. 4and gave them Nadrah (a light of beauty)} meaning, in their faces. 4And joy} in their hearts. Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, Abu 'Aliyah and Ar-RabT bin Anas all stated this.13 * This is similar to Allah's statement, At-Tabari 24:100. 121 At-Tabari 24 :99 At-Tabari 24:101.

413. Reclining therein on raised couches, they will see there neither the excessive heat, nor the excessive cold.} 414. And the shade thereof is close upon them, and the bunches of fruit thereof will hang low within their reach.} 415. And among them will be passed round vessels of silver and cups of crystal -} 416. (Qawdrir) Crystal- clear, made of silver. They will determine the measure thereof.} 417. And they will be given to drink there of a cup (of wine) mixed with Zanjabil (ginger),} 418. A spring there, called Salsabtl.} 419. And round about them will (serve) boys of everlasting youth . If you see them, you would think them scattered pearls.} 420. And when you look there (in Paradise), you will see a delight (that cannot be imagined), and a great dominion.} 421. Their garments will be of fine green silk, and Istabraq. They will be adorned with bracelets of silver, and their Lord will give them a purifying drink.} 422. (And it will be said to them): "Verily, this is a reward for you, and your endeavor has been accepted."} The raised Couches and the lack of Heat and Cold Allah tells us about the people of Paradise and the eternal delights they will experience, as well as the comprehensive ^ mmm ov fyj) j5jS \$\$

294 Tafslr Ibn Kathir favors that they will be given. Allah says, £q c*0} iReclining therein on raised couches.} This has already been discussed in Surat As-Saffat and the difference of opinion about

the meaning of reclining. Is it lying down, reclining on the elbows, sitting down cross-legged, or being firmly seated? We have also mentioned that the Al-Ara'ik are couches beneath curtained canopies. Concerning Allah's statement, ithey will see there neither the excessive heat, nor the excessive bitter cold.} meaning, there will be no disturbing heat with them, nor any painful cold, rather there will only be one climate that will be always and eternal and they will not want it to be changed. The Shade and Fruit Clusters will be near iAnd the shade thereof is close upon them.} meaning, the branches will be close to them. sm;} }And the bunches of fruit thereof will hang low within their reach.} meaning,

whenever he attempts to get any fruit, it will come nearer to him and come down from its highest branch as if it hears and obeys. This is as Allah says in another Ayah, iAnd fruits of the two gardens will be near at hand.} (55:54) Allah also says, iThe fruits in bunches whereof will be low and near at hand.} (69:23) Mujahid said,

iAnd the bunches offruit thereof will hang low within their reach.} “If he stands it will rise with him an equal amount, if he sits it will lower itself for him so that he can reach it and if he lies down it will lower itself for him more so that he can reach it. So this is Allah’s statement, iwill hang low within their reach}.’ Qatadah said, “No thorn or distance will repel their hands away from it (the fruit).”² Vessels of Silver and DrinkingCups Allah says, j-*? Jt M'S iAnd among them will be passed round vessels of silver and cups of crystal} meaning, servants will go around them with containers of food made of silver and cups of drink. These are drinking vessels that do not have handles or spouts. Then Allah says, 4A? ^ Ws i(Qaiuarir) Crystal-clear, made of silver.} Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others have all said, “It (Qatuarir) is the whiteness of silver in the transparency of glass.”¹³¹ Qawarir is only made of glass. So these cups are made of silver, but due to their fine thinness,

what is inside of them will be visible from outside of them (as

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6241–6250]

if they are glass). This is among the things of which there is nothing like in this world. Allah said, ' &) £>} 111 At-Tabari 24:103. 121 At-Tabari 24:103. At-Tabari 24:105, 106.

4They will determine the measure thereof.} meaning, according to the amount that will quench their thirst. It will not be more than that nor less than it, rather it will be prepared in an amount that is suitable for quenching the thirst of their drinkers. This is the meaning of the statement of Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Ibn Abza, ‘Abdullah bin TJBayd bin OJmayr, Ash-Sha*bi and Ibn Zayd. This was stated by Ibn Jarir and others * This is the most excellent provision, distinction and honor. The Ginger Drink and the Drink of Salsabil Allah says, dr }And they will be given to drink there of a cup mixed with ZanjabTl (ginger),} meaning, they - the righteous - will also be given a drink from these cups. id?} ia cup} meaning, a drink of wine. imixed with Zanjabd (ginger),} So on one occasion they will be given a drink that is mixed with camphor, and it is cool. Then on another occasion they will be given a drink mixed with ginger, and it is hot. This is so that their affair will be balanced. However, those who are nearest to Allah, they will drink from all of it however they wish, as Qatadah and others have said. 121 The statement of Allah has already preceded which says, id\ ift ± td} iA spring wherefrom the servants of Allah will drink.} (76:6) And here Allah says, I 1 At-Jabari 24:106, 107, and Al-Qurtubi 19:141. At-Jabari 24:107.

& ft 4A spring there, called Salsabil.} meaning, the ginger will be in a spring in Paradise that is called Salsabil. Ikrimah said, “It (Salsabil) is the name of a spring in Paradise.” Mujahid said, “It is called this due to its continuous flowing and the severity of its current.” The Boys and Servants Allah says, 'r& \ A& 4And round about them will (serve) boys of everlasting youth. If you see them, you would think them scattered pearls.} meaning, young boys from the boys of Paradise will go around serving the people of Paradise. ^everlasting youth.} meaning, in one state forever which they will be never

changing from, they will not increase in age. Those who have described them as wearing earrings in their ears have only interpreted the meaning in such a way because a child is befitting of this description and not an adult man. Concerning Allah's statement, *Arif* (•r'jj iffyou see them, you would think them scattered pearls.) meaning, when you see them dispersing to fulfill the needs of their masters, their great number, their beautiful faces, handsome colors, fine clothing and ornaments, you would think that they were scattered pearls. There is no better quality than this, nor is there anything nicer to look at than scattered pearls in a beautiful place. Allah says, *And when you look* meaning, "when you see it, O m At-Tabari 24 :108

Muhammad.' <? ithere) meaning, there. This refers to Paradise and its beauty, its vastness, its loftiness and the joy and happiness it contains. You will see a delight, and a great dominion meaning, there will be a great kingdom that belongs to Allah and a dazzling, splendid dominion. It has been confirmed in the Sahth. that Allah will say to the last of the people of the Fire to be taken out of it, and the last of the people to enter into Paradise, *Verily, you will have similar to the world and ten worlds like it* (in addition to If this is what He will give to the least of those who will be in Paradise, then what do you think about the one who will have a higher status and will be favored even more by Allah? The Garments and Ornaments Allah says, *Their garments will be of fine green silk, and Istabraq.* meaning, among the garments of the people of Paradise is silk and Sundus, which is a high quality silk. These garments will be shirts and similar clothing from the undergarments. Concerning Istabraq (velvet), from it there is that which has a glitter and shimmer to it, and it is that which is worn as outer clothes, just as is well-known in clothing. & >\$ 4They will be adorned with bracelets of silver This is a description of the righteous. In reference to those who will be near to Allah, then their description is as Allah m Muslim 1 :173.

says, *Wherein they will be adorned with bracelets of gold and pearls and their garments therein will be of silk.* (22:23) After Allah mentions the outward beautification with silk and ornaments, He then says, *And We will give them a purifying drink.* meaning, it will purify their insides of envy, despise, hatred, harm and the other reprehensible character traits. This is just as we have recorded from the Commander of the believers, 'Ali bin Abi Talib, that he said, "When the people of Paradise come to the Gate of Paradise, they will find two springs there. Then it will be as if they were inspired with what to do, so they will drink from one of them and Allah will remove whatever harmfulness there may be within them. Then they will bathe in the other spring and a glow of delight will run all over them. Thus, Allah informs of their outward condition and their inner beauty." 1 11 Allah then says, *Verily, this is a reward for you, and your endeavor has been accepted.* meaning, this will be said to them in honor of them and as a goodness towards them. This is as Allah says, *Eat and drink at ease for that which you have sent forth before you in days past!* (69:24) Allah also says. *And it will be cried out to them : "This is the Paradise which you have inherited for what you used to do."* (7:43) Then Allah says. 111 Al-Qurtubi 19:47.

Itt < ,/ A ' ^ f^ 8@ ^ <\$2fcse> ^L\$ *^4 0 :TS jiS|\$ ^ *tiJjWJ.uj'lLijUj 4<wd your endeavor has been accepted^ mean- ing, 'Allah the Exalted will reward you for a small amount (of deeds) with a large amount (of reward).' SC\$K M C£ ^ X> <*£> ^"4 Jj-S HP&r ji c< ^ {4 %4J'j ;j& jc; & * j^s\$& *y£ 3& ^>1 £j; (**»Uj ajuij til; i2i iSiS^ ;j£c ..j£ 3) £ «ill i2> & ky&G .*£5 4 *S*;M or 'if4 ft its 01 V) jjfiS i;

<@tf <&? C*~^£p>Sil jjJcy "-A>^ "4W '-^~* 4,,tt..' ^5*j{i)y^ (iiojllCj^ ^ 4.23. Verily, it is \Ne Who have sent down the Qur'an to you by stages.> Therefore be patient with constancy to the command of your Lord, and obey neither a sinner nor a disbeliever among them 425. And remember the Name ofyour Lord every morning and afternoon .} 426. And during the night, prostrate yourself to Him, and glorify Him a long night through. 427. Verily, these love the present life of this world, and put

behind them a heavy Day.} 428. It is We Who created them, and We have made them of strong build. And when We will, We can replace them with others like them with a complete replacement.} 429. Verily, this is an admonition, so whosoever wills, let him take a path to his Lord.} 430. But you cannot will, unless Allah wills. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 431 . He will admit to His mercy whom He wills and as for the wrongdoers - He has prepared a painful torment.} Mention ofthe Qur'an's Revelation and the Command to be Patient and remember Allah Allah reminds His Messenger 3^5 of how He blessed him by revealing the Magnificent Qur'an to him. j%*&} 4'Fherefore be patient with constancy to the command of your Lord.,} meaning, 'just as you have been honored by what has been revealed to you, then be patient with His decree and decision and know that He will handle your affairs in a good manner.' 3' 4And obey neither a sinner (Athim) nor a disbeliever (Kafur) among them.} meaning, 'do not obey the disbelievers and the hypocrites if they wish to deter you from what has been revealed to you. Rather convey that which has been revealed to you from your Lord and put your trust in Allah, for verily, Allah will protect you from the people.' The Athim is the sinner in his deeds and the Kafur is the disbeliever in his heart. ij&&p pj> 4And remember the Name of your Lord every morning and afternoon.} meaning, at the beginning of the day and at its end.

302 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr iAnd during the night, prostrate yourself to Him, and glorify Him a long night through.} This is similar to Allah's statement, iAnd in some parts of the night offer the Salah with it (the Qur'an), as an additional prayer (Tajhajjud) for you. It may be that you Lord will raise you to Maqdm Mahmud.} (17:79) Similarly, Allah also says, ^ V.MT iO you wrapped! Stand all night, except a little. Half of it or a little less than that, or a little more. And recite the Qur'an Tarttt.}(73:1-4) The Censure ofLove for the World and informing about the Day ofthe Final Return Allah reprimands the disbelievers and those similar to themwho love the world and are devoted and dedicated to it, who put the abode ofthe Hereafterbehindthem in disregard. He says; CJ j&TJS iVerily, these love the present life of this world, and put behind them a heavy Day.} meaning, the Day ofJudgement. Then Allah says, ilt is We Who created them, and We have made them ofstrong build.} Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and others have said, "This means their creation."111 ilp&g ^ 6* Zfr iAnd when We will. We can replace them with others like them with a complete replacement.} At-Tabari 24:118.

meaning, "when We wish, We will resurrect them on the Day of Judgement and change them, repeating their creation in a new form.' Here the beginning of their creation is a proof for the repetition of their creation. Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir both said, m: e iAnd when We will. We can replace them with others like them with a complete replacement.} "This means, ifWe wish We can bring another group of people besides them (in their place)." * This is like Allah's statement, Hf He wills, He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is capable over that.} (4:133) This is also like His statement, ilf He wills, He can remove you and bring a new creation! Andfor Allah that is not hard or difficult.} (14:19-20) TheQur'an isaReminder,andGuidancecomesfromthe Help ofAllah Allah then says, iVerily,

this is an admonition,} meaning, this Surah is a reminder. }so whosoever wills, let him take a path to his Lord.} meaning, a path and a way. This means, whoever wishes to be guided by the Qur'an. This is similar to Allah's statement, iAnd what loss have they if they had believed in Allah and in the Last Day.} (4:39) Then Allah says, V Al-Tabari 24 : 1 18 , 1 19

304 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iCj J \Zj} iBut you cannot will, unless Allah wills.} meaning, no one is able to guide himself, enter into faith or bring about any benefit for himself, or iif it oi 4Unless Allah wills. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All- Wise.} meaning, He is Most Knowledgeable of who deserves to be guided. So, He makes guidance easy for him and He predestines for him that which will be a cause for it. However, whoever deserves misguidance, He averts guidance from him. Unto Him belongs the most excellent wisdom and the most irrefutable argument. Thus, He says, iteZ- ctf sft l\} iVerily, Allah is Ever All-Knowing, All-Wise.} Then He says, Uie pk Jet O^UiS[] j ills 4He will admit to His mercy whom He wills and as for the wrongdoers - He has prepared a painful torment.} meaning, He guides whomever He wishes and He leads astray whomever He wishes. Whoever He guides, there is no one who can lead him astray; and whoever He leads astray, there is no one who can guide him.

Surah 77: Al-Mursalat

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6251]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Mursalat (Chapter - 77)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6251–6266]

The Revelation of this Surat and its Recitation in the Maghrib Prayer Al-Bukhari recorded from ‘Abdullah - that is Ibn Mas‘ud - that he said, “While we were with the Messenger of Allah[^] in a cave at Mina, \$By the Mursalat.} was revealed to him. He was reciting it and I was learning it from his mouth. Verily, his mouth was moist with it when a snake leaped out at us. The Prophet said, I Kill it/» So we quickly went after it, but it got away. Then the Prophet[^] said, pJj Ui ijJ jl cj> «/f was saved from your harm just as you all were saved from its harm.n”* 11 Muslim also recorded this Hadith by way of Al-A‘mashJ2 Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas, who reported from his mother that she heard the Prophet sgg reciting 4By the Mursalat.} in the Maghrib prayer.131 In a report from Malik on the authority of Ibn ‘Abbas, he narrated thatUmm Al- Fadl (his mother) heard him (Ibn ‘Abbas) reciting III Path Al-Bari 4 :42 121 Muslim 4:1755. •3| Ahmad 6 :338

4By the Mursalat ‘Urfa.) (77:1) so she said, “O my son! You reminded me with your recitation of this Surat. Verily, it is the last thing I heard from the Messenger of Allah jg. He recited it in the Maghrib prayer (i.e., before he died). "I 1 * Both Al-Bukhari and Muslim recorded this report in the Two Sahihs by way of Malik. ^OP *— In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. •**/& 4^!^ PrP'i ^ # •P^Pj') % flat^ @£2 i& ri e e; ^ ^ 3\$ il. By the Mursalat ‘Urfa.) 42. The 'Asifat 'Asfa.) 43. And the Nashirat Nashra 44. Tire Fdriqdt that separate.) 45. The Mulqiydt that remind,) 46. Excusing or warning.) 47. Surely, what you are promised will occur.) 48 . Then when the stars lose their lights.) 49. And when Furiyat the heaven.) 410. And when the mountains are blown away.) 411. And when the Messengers are Uqqitat.) 412. For what Day are these signs postponed?) 413. For tire Day of Sorting Out (the men of Paradisefrom the men destinedfor Hell).) 414. And what will explain to you wlrat is the Day of Sorting Out?) 111 Muwatta' 1 :78 Fath Al-B&ri 2 :287 , and Muslim 1 :338

il5. Woe that Day to the deniers (of the Day of Resurrection)!} Allah's swearing by Different Creatures about the Occurrence ofthe Hereafter Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, 4By the Mursaldt 'Urfa.} “The angels.” From Masruq, Abu Ad- Duha, Mujahid in one narrations from him, As-Suddi and Ar- RabT bin Anas, statements similar to this have been reported. It has been reported from Abu Salih that he said, “These are the Messenger.” In another narration from him (Abu Salih) he said

that it means the angels. Abu Salih has also said the meaning of Al-'Asifat, An-Nashirat, Al-Fariqat and Al-Mulqiyat, that they all refer to the angels. Ath-Thawri narrated from Salamah bin Kuhayl, who reported from Muslim Al-Batin, who reported from Abu Al-TJbaydayn that he asked Ibn Mas'ud about the meaning of Al-Mursalat 'Urfa, and he (Ibn Mas'ud) said, "The wind." He said the same about Al-'Asifat 'Asfa and An-Nashirat Nashra, that they all refer to the wind.¹¹¹ Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah all said the same.¹²¹ Ibn Jarir confidently affirmed that Al-'Asifat 'Asfa means the wind just as Ibn Mas'ud and those who followed him said. However, he (Ibn Jarir) did not affirm whether An-Nashirat Nashra are the angels or the wind as has preceded. It has been reported from Abu Salih that An-Nashirat Nashra is the rain. The most obvious meaning is as Allah says, }And we send the winds fertilizing.} (15:22) He also says, 1 U \ •> *j>t iAnd it is He Wlw sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy (rain).} (7:57) At-Tabari 24:124, 125. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 24:123-126.

Similarly, Al-'Asifat are winds. It is said (in Arabic) that the winds 'Asifat when they make noise with their blowing. Likewise, An-Nashirat are the winds that scatter into clouds in the horizons of the sky according to the will of the Lord. Allah then says, ¥& *4^ iThe Fariqat that separate, the Mulqiydt that remind, excusing or warning. ^ meaning, the angels. This was said by Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Masruq, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, As-Suddi and Ath-Thawri.¹¹¹ There is no difference of opinion here, because they (the angels) are the ones who descend with Allah's command to the Messengers, separating between the truth and falsehood, guidance and misguidance, and the lawful and the forbidden. They bring the revelation to the Messengers, which contains exemption or absolvment for the creatures and a warning for them of Allah's torment if they oppose His command. Allah said, iSurely, what you are promised will occur. This is the subject of these oaths. This means, what you all have been promised concerning the establishment of the Hour (Judgement Day), the blowing of the horn, the resurrection of the bodies, the gathering of those of old and those of latter times on one common ground and the rewarding of eveiy doer of a deed based upon his deed. If he did good, then his reward will be good, and if he did evil, then his reward will be evil. All of this will occur, meaning it will come to pass and there is no avoiding it. A Mention of some of what will occur on the Day of Judgement Then Allah says, iThen when the stars lose their lights.} meaning, their light will m At-Tabari 24:128, 129.

leave. This is similar to Allah's statement, iAnd when the star fall.} (81:2) It is also similar to His statement. ^1*01 UiJf 4And when the stars havefallen and scattered.} (82:2) Then Allah says, iAnd when Furijat the heaven .} meaning, it is cleft asunder, becomes split, its sides fall and its edges become weak. i <0 iAnd when the mountains are blown away.} meaning, they will be removed and no sight or trace of them will remain. This is as Allah says, iAnd they ask you concerning the mountains : Say, "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust."} (20:105) Allah also says, *>* • f "•Iff v jJ* ujC iSjj pjy? iAnd (remember) the Day We shall cause the mountains to pass away (like clouds of dust), and you will see the earth as a leveled plain, and we shall gather them all together so as to leave not one of them behind.} (18:47) Then He says, iAnd when the Messengers are Uqqitat.} Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas that he said that Uqqitat means "Gathered." * Ibn Zayd said, "This is similar to Allah's statement, At-Tabari 24:129.

^ 'Ek }' & i On the Day when Allah will gather the Messengers together Mujahid said, iUqqitat.^ "This means postponed." 21 Ath-Thawri narrated from Mansur, who narrated from Ibrahim that he said concern- ing the word, <3!> iUqqitat.} "This means promised."131 It seems as though he holds this to be similar to Allah's statement, 4^' * & i And the earth will shine with the light of its Lord : and the Book will be produced ; and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward; and it will be judged between them with truth, and they will not be wronged.> (39:69) Then Allah says, 4For what Day are these signs postponed? For the Day of Sorting Out. And what will explain to you what is the Day of Sorting Out? Woe that Day to the deniers/\$ Allah is saying, Tor which day are the Messengers postponed and their matter expected, so that the Hour will be established?' This is as Allah says, 111 At-Tabari 24:130. 121 At-Tabari 24:130. 131 At-Tabari 24:130.

311 Surah 77. Al-Mursaldt (16-28) (Part-29 4 So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His Messen- gers. Certainly, Allah is Almighty, All-Able of Retribution . On the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the hea- vens, and they will ap- pear before Allah, the One, the Irresistible. (14:47, 48) This is the Day of Sorting Out, as Allah says, 4the Day of Sorting Out.} Then Allah says, in magnifying its matter, S> fa £ JtyiS Zj} iWk&i& msm? @a\ ^ ^ Cfl>j PISL\jy^l '&4\$ ->4 '51 oj jl? \$J 4 And what will explain to you what is the Day of Sorting Out? Woe that Day to the deniers.} meaning, woe unto them from Allah's torment that is coming in the future. '^ji* y* il fj 4 fi & it '4^-j & S o^/< 4*^ it ^JuSysK jUi ^ y^i 4*> <2 i\$tb> ^£ ^16. Did We not destroy the ancients?} 417. So shall We make later generations to follow them.} 418. Thus do We deal with the criminals.}

419. Woe that Day to the deniers!} 420. Did We not create you from a despised water?} 421 . Then We placed it in a place of safety,} 422 . For a known period?} 423. So We did measure; and We are the best to measure.} 424. Woe that Day to the deniers!} 425. Have We not made the earth Kifat (a receptacle)} 426. For the living and the dead?} 427 . And have placed therein fixed towers, and have given you Furd water?} 428. Woe that Day to the deniers!} The Call to contemplate the various Manifestations of Allah's Power Allah says. 4 Did We not destroy the ancients?} meaning, those who rejected the Messengers and opposed what they came to them with. p**? r 4 So shall We make later generations to follow them.} meaning, from those who are similar to them. Thus, Allah says, 4 Thus do We deal with the criminals. Woe that Day to the deniers!} Ibn Jarir said this . 111 Then Allah reminding His creatures of His favor, and using the beginning of creation to support the idea of repeating it, He says: to 4 Did We not create you from a despised water?} meaning, weak and despised in comparison to the power of IM At-Tabari 24:131.

323 Surah 77. Al-Mursalat (16-28) (Part-29 the Creator. This is similar to what has been reported in the Hadith of Busr bin Jahhash (that Allah says), <j4 hi jjj \$!>!' **"(O) Son of Adam ! How can you think that I am unable, and yet I created you from something like this (i.e., semen)?" *11 ' J} 4 i Then We placed it in a place of safety,} meaning, We gathered him in the womb, where the fluid of the man and the woman settles. The womb has been prepared for this, as a protector of the fluid deposited in it. Allah said: i For a known period?} meaning, for a fixed period of time, which is from six months to nine months. Thus, Allah says, i So We did measure; and We are the best to measure. Woe that Day to the deniers!} Then Allah says, i Have We not made the earth Kifat for the living and the dead?} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Kifat means a place of shelter." 2! Mujahid said, "It holds the dead so that nothing is seen of it."

* Ash- ShaTfi said, "Its interior is for your dead and its surface is for your living."141 Mujahid and Qatadah also said this.'5' [sty iAnd have placed therein fixed towers,} meaning, the mountains. The earth is held in place with them *** Ahmad 4:210. At-Jabari 24:131. At-Jabari 24:134. •4| At-Tabari 24:134. ,S| At-Jabari 24:134, 135.

so that it does not shake and sway. iatid have given you Furd water?} meaning, cold and delicious water from the clouds or from what He causes to gush forth from the springs of the earth. iWoe that Day to the deniers!} meaning, woe to whoever reflects upon these created things which demonstrate the greatness of their Creator, then after that continues to reject Him and disbelieve in Him. O; Vj ill! 1 L. dl lju jjj; Sij Ql pa %&\$\$\$%&% a a v fi ^ sr£ s?4 429. (It will be said to the disbelievers): "Depart you to that which you used to deny!"} 430. "Depart you to a shadow in three columns,"} "Neither shady nor of any use against the fierce flame of the Fire."} 432. Verily, it (Hell) throws sparks (huge) as Al-Qasr,} 433. As if they were Sufr camels.} 434. Woe that Day to the deniers (of the Day of Resurrection)!} 435. That will be a Day when they shall not speak (during some part of it),} 436. And they will not be permitted to putforth any excuse.} 437. Woe that Day to the deniers (of the Day of Resurrection)!} 438. That will be a Day of Decision! We have brought you and the men ofold together!} 439. So, ifyou have a plot, use it against Me (Allah)!} 440. Woe that Day to the deniers (of the Day of Resurrection)!}

The driving ofthe Criminals to their FinalAbode in Hell and how it will be done Allah informs about the disbelievers who deny the final abode, the recompense. Paradise, and the Hellfire. On the Day of Judgement it will be said to them: iDepart you to that which you used to deny! Depart you to a shadow in three columns,} meaning, a flame of fire when it rises and ascends with smoke. So due to its severity and strength, it will have three columns. iNeither shady nor of any use against the fierce flame of the Fire.} meaning, shade of the smoke that comes from the flame - which itself will not have a shade, nor will it benefit against the flame. This means it will not protect them from the heat of the flame. Allah said, iVerily, it throws sparks as Al-Qasr,} meaning, its sparks will shoot out from its flame like huge castles. Ibn Mas*ud said, "Like forts."111 Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Malik who reported from Zayd bin Aslam and others said, "This means the trunk of trees.",2, 4As if they were Sufr camels.} means, black camels. This is the view of Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, and Ad-Dahhak, and Ibn Jarir favored this view. Ibn 'Abbas Mujahid, and Said bin Jubayr said about, iSufr camels.} "Meaning ropes of ships." 111 At-Tabari 24:163. AMabari 24:138.

iVerily, it (Hell) throws sparks as Al-Qasr.} Imam Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said: "We were directed to the timber a length of three cubits or more in order to use it for construction of buildings. We used to call it Al-Qasr. 4As if they were Sufr camels. These (Jimalaf) are ropes of ships that are bundled until they resemble the intestines of men." it iV\oe that Day to the deniers!} The Inability ofthe Criminals to speak, make Excuses, or step forward on the Day ofJudgement Then Allah says, iThat will be a Day when they shall not speak,^ meaning, they will not speak. A & iAnd they will not be permitted to putforth any excuse . meaning, they will not be able to speak, nor will they be granted permission to speak so that they can make excuses. Rather, the proof will be established against them, and they will be called upon to speak about the wrong that they did, but they will not be able to say anything. The courts of the Day of Judgement will occur in stages. Sometimes the Lord informs of

this stage and sometimes He informs of that stage. This is to show the terrors and calamities of that Day. Thus, after all the details of this discussion, He says: it' m FathAl-Bdri8:556.

4Woe that Day to the deniers!} Then Allah says, %&4^4% ¥ l-'- iThat will be a Day of Decision! We have brought you and the men ofold together! So ifyou have a plot, use it against Me!} This is an address from the Creator to His servants. He says to them, iThat will be a Day of Decision! We have brought you and the men ofold together!} meaning, He will gather all of them by His power on one common plane, He will make them hear the caller and He will cause them to see. Then He says, frjr4} iSo, ifyou have a plot, use it against Me!} This is a serious threat and a harsh warning. It means, “ifyou are able to save yourselves from being seized by Me, and rescue yourselves from My ruling, then do so. But you are certainly not able to do so.’ This is as Allah says, V IjjjS Oi- J jj 40 assembly of Jinn and men! If you have power to pass beyond the zones of the heavens and the earth, then pass beyond (them)! But you will never be able to pass them, except with authority (from Allah)!} (55:33) Allah also says, iAnd you will not harm Him in the least.} (11:57) It is narrated in a Hadlth (that Allah said), Jj~& ‘ui l) (^! l’0 My servants! You all can never attain My benefit and thereby benefit Me, and you all can never attain My harm and

thereby harm Me/s11 ’ jt i~ lit Sg»3 & 4 \$i» *a .. j^y Jy *£ jjC—>»i^ bj^ ,^ u_yb«w*j Ji> ^0i»j43* V t>& 2* Ji m3 ^fpSss^! ^2 jj> l|Pi>v? <®S£5 Verily, those who had Taqwa, shall be amidst shades and springs.) 442. Andfruits, such as they desire.) 443. "Eat and drink comfortably for that which you used to do.") 444. Verily, thus We reward the Muhsinm.) 445. Woe that Day to the deniers!) 446. Eat and enjoy yourselves for a little while. Verily, you are criminals.) 447. Woe that Day to the deniers!) 448. And when it is said to them: “Bow down yourself." They bow not down.) 449. Woe that Day to the deniers!) 450. Then in wlmst statement after this will they believe?) The FinalAbode for ThoseWho have Taqwa. Allah informs that His servants who have Taqwa. and worship Him by performing the obligations and abandoning the forbidden things, will be in gardens and springs on the Day of Judgement. This means they will be in the opposite condition of the wretched people, who will be in shades of Al-YahmUm, which is purtrid, black smoke. Allah says, 4And fruits, such as they desire.) meaning, and from other types of fruits, they will have whatever they request. t1 * Muslim 4 :1994.

iEat and drink comfortablyfor that which you used to do.} meaning, this will be said to them out of kindness for them. Reestablishing what He has previously mentioned, Allah says; iVerily, thus We reward the Muhsinm .} meaning, “this is Our reward for whoever does good deeds.’ iWoe that Day to the deniers!} A Threat forWhoever denies the Day ofJudgement Allah says, hu& iEat and enjoy yourselves for a little while. Verily, you are criminals.} This is an address to the deniers of the Day of Judgement. It is commanding them with a command of threat and intimidation. Allah says, iEat and enjoy yourselvesfor a little while.} meaning, for a period of time that is short, small and brief. iVerily, you are criminals.} meaning, then you all will be driven to the fire of Hell which has already been mentioned. iWoe that Day to the deniers!} This is similar to Allah’s statement. iWe let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to a great torment.} (31:24) Allah also says,

Surah 78: An-Naba

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6267–6280]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Beneficent, the Most Merciful. ¹ 'i -jv | J 'Ey CWj jCij jii jl 'jjUII. bW- J iL-* |^j> ll^J UL»-J J^l Um-j iijjfcL viiS £ .» Gp. \$<\$ *^ Si C\$J 4;f^u1 41 . HTwf are they asking about?} 42. About the great news,} 43. About zvhich they are in disagreement.} 44 . Nay, they will come to know!} 45. Nay, again, they will come to know!} 46. Have We not made the earth as a bed,} 47. And the mountains as pegs?} 48. And We have created you in pairs.} 49. And We have made your sleep as a thingfor rest.} 410. And We have made the night as a covering,} 411. And We have made the dayfor livelihood.} 412. And We have built above you seven strong,} 413. And We have made (therein) a shining lamp.} 414. And We have sent down front the Mu'sirat water Thajjdj.} 415. That We may produce therewith grains and vegetations,} 416. And gardens that are Alfaf.}

who are in it. Then Allah says, 4And We have created you in pairs.} meaning, male and female, both of them enjoying each other, and by this means procreation is achieved. This is similar to Allah's statement, •V A. 4And among His signs is this that He created for you wives from among yourselves, that you may find repose in them, and He has put between you affection and mercy.} (30:21) 4And We have made your sleep as a thingfor rest.} meaning, a cessation of movement in order to attain rest from the frequent repetition and going about in search of livelihood during the day. A similar Ayah has been mentioned previously in SHrat Al-Furqan. 4And We have made the night as a covering,} meaning, its shade and darkness covers the people. This is as Allah says, 4 \$f} 4By the night as it conceals it.} (91:4) Qatadah commented; 4And We have made the night as a covering,} meaning, a tranquil residence. Concerning Allah's statement, j\$t 4And We have made the dayfor livelihood.} meaning, We made it radiant, luminous, and shining so that the people would be able to move about in it.' By it they are

325Surah 78. An-Naba' (1-16) (Part-30) Concerning Allah's statement, &} iwater Thajjaj} Mujahid, Qatadah, and Ar-Rabl' bin Anas all said, "Thajjaj means poured out."111 At-Thawri said, "Continuous."121 Ibn Zayd said, "Abundant."131 In the Hadlth of the woman with prolonged menstrual bleeding, when the Messen- ger ofAllah said to her, 4AJ */ suggest you to make an absorbent cloth for yourself.*" Meaning, 'dress the area with cotton.' The woman replied, "O Messenger of Allah! It (the bleeding) is too much for that. Verily, it flows in profusely (Thajja)."14 ' This contains an evidence for using the word Thajj to mean abundant, continuous and flowing. And Allah knows best. Allah said, iThat We may produce therewith com and vegetation, and gardens that are Alfaf.} meaning, 'so that We may bring out great abundance, goodness, benefit, and blessing through this water.' it} igrains^ This refers to that which is preserved for (the usage) of humans and cattle. m} iand vegetations} meaning, vegetables that are eaten fresh. i+tj} iAnd gardens} meaning, gardens of various fruits, differing colors,

and a wide variety of tastes and fragrances, even if it is ingathered at one location of the earth. This is why Allah says 111 At-Tabari 24 : 155 121 At-Tabari 24 : 155 At-Tabari 24:155. Abu Dawud 1 :199.

J mm oAT mzm A. ?Si j_ ^l^ jLTj_ ^yj)Ol^lillll Vj'ij4^i^ 0Cis>34 i£4= 4ljlp'iOi Ss^Sj &454y> ^QjfrV)j^Juj^biyj^^C -^'6=>^4^ 4And gardens that are Alfaf.} Ibn 'Abbas and other said, "Alfaf means gathered."11 This is similar to Al- lah's statement, £ ^V(j> * '/' »*** *'• * # » '.++ &£i (MJ y^' 0- T> ^ .' - >.f - i» ' jUj 41-J y'jr<f Jf'j i>'jr*e JaM s_jc 04 J-iiy 4 ol 4^4/f 4 4And in the earth are neighboring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops, and date palms, growing into two or three from a single stem root, or otherwise, watered with the same water; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Verily, in these things there are Ayatfor the people who understand.} (13:4) 26 S2lf @0# \$2 4g £0^ pit £ k> <jCJ ffl tali* Oviddl v.T >-4>- o) v.i'iOr* c>6 JI.il Cnji (*ri *!)-'!• £-*• "i) Vj <£* 1^* jyjj* V @(*"-1 ijj &3»@04= fc£d & £§6jC itfg@04 4 'f-,0j* 'VI j£jL.> J& 417. Verily, the Day ofDecision is a fixed time,} ^liUlt c£*rj (1) At-Tabari 24:156.

418. The Day when the Trumpet will be blown, and you shall come forth in crowds.4 419. And the heaven shall be opened, and it will become as gates. 420. And the mountains shall be moved away from their places and they will be as if they were a mirage. 421. Truly, Hell is a place of ambush} 422. A dwelling place for the Taghiin,} 423. They will abide therein Ahqab.} 424. Nothing cool shall they taste therein, nor any drink . 425. Except Hamlrn, and Ghassdq4 426. An exact recompense (according to their evil crimes). 427. For verily, they used not to look for a reckoning.} 428. But they denied Our Aydt Kidhhaba.} 429. And all things We have recorded in a Book.} 430. So taste you. No increase shall We give you, except in torment.} Explaining the Day of Decision and what occurs during it Allah says about the Day of Decision - and it is the Day of Judgement - that it is at a fixed time, with a set appointment. Its time cannot be added to or decreased. No one knows its exact time except Allah. This is as Allah says, 4And We delay it only for a term fixed.} (11:104) 4M\$& Gi fj>} 4The Day when the Trumpet will be blown, and you shall come forth in crowds.} Mujahid said, "Groups after groups."111 Ibn Jarir said, "This means that each nation will come with its Messenger. It is similar to Allah's statement, 111 At-Tabari 24:158.

328 Tafoir Ibn Kathir 4The Day when We shall call together all human beings with their Imam .> (17:7l)"11 ' Al-Bukhari reported concerning the explanation of Allah's statement, 4The Day when the Trumpet will be blown, and you shall come forth in crowds Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 11That which is between the two blowings is forty Someone asked, "Is it forty days, O Abu Hurayrah?" But he (Abu Hurayrah) refused to reply, saying "no comment." They then asked, "Is it forty months?" But he (Abu Hurayrah) refused to reply, saying "no comment." They asked again, "Is it forty years?" But he (Abu Hurayrah) refused to reply, saying "no comment." (Abu Hurayrah added:) "Then the Prophet jg went on to say, Vi *i>- jLl^l j* 'J^Jl ^44 I . ^ji 4 US' j *U *ILUl <jj I JyJ ^ Jill y>j tU>-lj Uiif- VI "Then Allah will send down a rain from the sky and the dead body will sprout just as a green plant sprouts. Every part of the last person will deteriorate except for one bone, and it is the coccyx bone (tailbone). From it the creation will be assembled on the Day of Judgement.»"121 aa sat 4And the heaven shall be opened, and it will become as gates. meaning, paths, and routes for the descending of the angels. as jcn At-Tabari 24:158. FathAl-Bari 8:558.

329 Surah 78. An-Naba' (17-30) (Part-30) 4And the mountains shall be moved away from their places and they will be as if they were a mirage.} This is similar to Allah's statement, > J)) jCi' tSjj} 4And you will see the mountains and think them solid, but they shall pass away as the passing away of the clouds. (27:88) He also says, ofCs} 4And the mountain will be like carded wool.} (101:5) And Allah says here, <zJ&} 4As if they were a mirage.} meaning, they appear to the one who looks at them as if they are something, but they are actually nothing. After this they will be completely removed. Nothing will be seen of them, and there will be neither base nor trace of them. This is as Allah says, Zfy teli Laji-j Jii tjUAl ge 4 V) 4And they ask you concerning the mountains, say : "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust. Then He shall leave them as a level smooth plain. You will see therein nothing crooked or curved."} (20:105-107) And He says, 4'if iaN"" iEjj JCj-' jf* pp} 4And the Day We shall cause the mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a leveled plain.} (18:47) Allah then says. iTruly, Hell is a place of ambush} meaning, it is waiting in preparation.

ifor the Taghiin} These are the disobedient rejectors who oppose the Messengers. ite.} 4A dwelling place} meaning, a place of return, final destination, final outcome, and residence. Allah said, iThey will abide therein Ahqab.} meaning, they will remain in it for Ahqab, which is the plural of Huqb. Huqb means a period of time. Khalid bin Ma'dan said, "This Ayah, and the Ayah, i\$ its £ iexcept your Lord wills.} (11:107) both refer to the people of Tawhid.'^ Ibn Jarir recorded this statement. Ibn Jarir also recorded from Salim that he heard Al-Hasan being asked about Allah's statement, 4cpiid 'q hJ} iThey will abide therein Ahqab} "In reference to Ahqab, it has no specific amount of time other than its general meaning of eternity in the Hellfire. However, they have mentioned that the Huqb is seventy years, and every day of it is like one thousand years according to your reckoning (in this life)."12' Said reported from Qatadah that he said, "Allah says, iThey will abide therein Ahqab.} (78:23) And it is that which has no end to it. Whenever one era comes to an end, a new era follows it. It has been mentioned to us that the Huqb is eighty years."*31 Ar-RabT bin Anas said, i^m%y iThey will abide therein Ahqab} "No one knows how much time At-Tabari 24:162. ,a| At-Tabari 24:162. 131 At-Tabari 24:162.

this Ahqab is, except for Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. It has been mentioned to us that one Huqb is eighty years, and the year is three hundred and sixty days, and each day is equivalent to one thousand years according to your reckoning (in this life)." Ibn Jarir has recorded both of these state- ments. 11 ' Allah's statement: ft iNothing cool shall they taste therein, nor any drink> meaning, they will not find any coolness in Hell for their hearts, nor any good drink for them to partake of. Thus, Allah says, i&J&j 'Or 4Except Hamim, and Ghassaq} Abu Al-'Aliyah said, "The Hamim has been made an exception to the coolness, and Ghassaq is the exception to the drink. ' This has also been said by Ar- Rabi' bin Anas. In reference to the Hamim, it is the heat that has reached its maximum temperature and point of boiling. The Ghassag131 is gathered from the pus, sweat, tears, and wounds of the people of Hellfire. It is unbearably cold with an intolerable stench. May Allah save us from that by His beneficence and grace. Then He continues, 4An exact recompense .^ meaning, that which will happen to them of this punishment is in accordance with their wicked deeds, which they were doing in this life. Mujahid, Qatadah, and others have said thisJ4 ' Then Allah said, 4For verily, they used not to lookfor a reckoning.} (78:27) meaning, they did not believe that there would be an abode in 111 At-Tabari 24:162. 121 At-Tabari 24:165. '3 ' These terms often appear translated as "boiling water" and "dirty wound discharge." 141 Al-Tabari 24:167.

which they would be taken to account. But they denied Our Aydt Kidhdhaba meaning, they used to deny the evidences of Allah and His proofs for His creation, which He revealed to His Messengers. So they met these proofs with rejection and obstinance. His statement, iKidhdhaba} it means rejection, and it is considered a verbal noun that does not come from a verb. Allah said; iAnd all things We have recorded in a Book meaning, ‘surely We know the deeds of all of the creatures, and We have written these deeds for them. We will reward them based upon this.’ If their deeds were good then their reward will be good, and if their deeds were evil their reward will be evil. Allah then says, iSo taste you. No increase shall We give you, except in torment. This means that it will be said to the people of the Hellfire, “Taste that which you were in. We will never increase you in anything except torment according to its type (of sin), and something else similar to it.” Qatadah. reported from Abu Ayyub Al-Azdi, who reported from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr that he said, “Allah did not reveal any Ayah against the people of the Hellfire worse than this Ayah, iSo taste you. No increase shall We give you, except in torment.Y’ Then he said, “They will continue increasing in torment forever.”¹¹¹ m At-Tabari 24:169.

Qs v ufSfc ^3*ju* ooLu, <\$£» at icj jj 5> ^{o£ 'Jj 431. Verily, for those who have Taqwa, there will be a success;} 432. Hada'iq and vineyards,4 433. And Kawd'ib Atrab,} 434. And a cup Dihdq.} 435. No Laghw shall they hear therein, nor lying;} 436. Rewardedfrom your Lord with a sufficient gift.} The Great Success will be for ThoseWho have Taqwa Allah informs about the happy people and what He has prepared for them of esteem, and eternal pleasure. Allah says, iVerily, for those who have Taqwa, there will be a success;} Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak both said, “A place of enjoyable recreation.”¹¹¹ Mujahid and Qatadah both said, “They are successful and thus, they are saved from the Hellfire.”¹²¹ The most obvious meaning here is the statement of Ibn ‘Abbas, because Allah says after this, i\$£} iHada'iq} And Hada'iq are gardens of palm trees and other things. 4And vineyards, and Kawd'ib Atrab,} meaning, wide-eyed maidens with fully developed breasts. Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and others have said, 4c^-iJ>} iKawd'ib} “This means round breasts. They meant by this that the breasts of these girls will be fully rounded and not sagging, ** At-Tabari 24 :170, and Al-Baghawi 4 :439. 121 At-Tabari 24:169, 170.

because they will be virgins, equal in age. This means that they will only have one age.”

The explanation of this has already

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6280–6284]

been mentioned in Surat Al-Waqi‘ah. 12] Concerning Allah’s statement, i:i&j dft iAnd a cup Dihaq.\$ Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Continuously filled.”*3 ‘Ikrimah said, “Pure.” Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, and Ibn Zayd all said, iDihaq} “This means completely filled. ”*4 ' Then Allah says, %0 fe iNo Laghw shall they hear therein, nor lying;} This is similar to Allah’s statement, % ft0 4Freefrom any Laghw, andfreefrom sin.} (52:23) meaning, there will not be any vain, worthless speech therein, nor any sinful lying. Rather, it will be the abode of peace, and everything that is in it will be free of any shortcomings. Allah then says, it jcj ?£} ^Rewardedfrom your Lord with a sufficient gift.} meaning, “this that We have mentioned to you is what Allah will reward them with, and they will be given it by His favor and from Him. It will be a kindness, mercy, gift, and recompense from Him. It will be sufficient, suitable, comprehensive and abundant.’ The Arabs say, “He gave me and he sufficed me.” This means that he

sufficiently provided for me.” From this comes the saying, “Allah is sufficient for a ” *** At-Tabari 24 : 170, and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :398 * See volume nine, the Tafsirof SuratAl-Waqi‘ah (56:37). At-Tabari 24:173. At-Tabari 24:172.

g @ciu^\$% ^5\$ “V \iS '££.Uj q£)' fy; 3 oil ^ -it “,y.i \$1 ;p£» j»ij *i>j dl ‘l- _4o-^ li-j* C’j* f^jjl >&“ m;^ c #» 4&B^ 437. The Lord of the heavens and the earth, and whatsoever is in between them, the Most Gracious, withWhom th- eycannotdare to speak .> 438. The Day that Ar- Ruh and the angels will standforth in rows, they will not speak except him whom Ar-Rahman allows, and he will speak what is right> 439. That is the True Day. So, whosoever wills, let him seek a place with His Lordly 440. Verily, We have warned you ofa near torment - the Day when man will see that which his hands have sent forth, and the disbeliever will say : "Woe to me! Would that I were dust/"> No one will dare to speak before Allah - not even the Angels - without first receiving Permission Allah informs of His magnificence and His majesty, and that He is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, and whatever is in them and between them. He explains that He is the Most Gracious, Whose mercy covers all things. Then He says, 4fe iL\$2 V>

iWith Whom they cannot dare to speak.} meaning, no one is able to begin addressing Him except by His permission. This is as Allah says, 4*45% jiia ifjft li if} AWho is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} (2:255) It is also similar to His statement, 4*45% J- ft==c v tX fjfr iOn the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His leave.} (11:105) AC#Z. ^ (t \$ \$0 iThe Day that Ar-Ruh and the angels will standforth in rows, they will not speak} (78:38) The word Rah here is referring to the angel Jibril. This has been said by Ash-Sha*bi, Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Pahhak.' This is as Allah says, 4ic^*5U ^ A&} AWhich the trustworthy Rilh has brought down. Upon your heart that you may be of the wamers.} (26:193-194) Muqatil bin Hayyan said, “The Rah is the noblest of the angels, the closest of them to the Lord, and the one who delivers the revelation.”12' Allah said; os) o4 iexcept him wlwm Ar-Rahman allows,} This is similar to Allah’s statement, 4*45%, “^1 y ot pi} iOn the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His leave.} (11:105) This is similar to what has been confirmed in the Sahih, that At-Tabari 24:176, and Al-Qurpibi 19:186. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :400

the Prophet said, •j4*> «And none will speak on that Day except the Messengers Allah said, i<&> iand he will speak what is right.} meaning, the truth. And from the truth is the fact that there is no god worthy of worship except Allah. This is as Abu Salih and Tkrimah both said.*2 * In reference to Allah’s statement, iThat is the Trite Day.} meaning, it will come to pass and there is no avoiding it. £j>} iSo, whosoever wills, let him seek a place with His Lord!} meaning, a place of return, a path that leads to Him, and a way that he may pass by to get to Him. The Day ofJudgement is Near Allah said, p£\ q} } Verily, We have warned you ofa near torment} meaning, the Day of Judgement. It is mentioned here to emphasize the fact that its occurrence has become close, because everything that is coming will certainly come to pass. i\c c % ;;> ithe Day when man will see that which his hands have sent forth,} meaning, all of his deeds will be presented to him - the good and bad, and the old and new. This is similar to Allah’s statement, * l * FathAl-Bari 13:430. At-Tabari 24:178.

ijU. U \jjlfj} iAnd they will find all that they did, placed before them.} (18:49) It is also similar to His statement, %&£ frf <&¥ iOn that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind.} (75:13) Then Allah says, <03&J4 ’}P iand the disbeliever will say : “Woe to me! Would that I

were dust!”} meaning, the disbeliever on that Day will wish that he had only been dust in the worldly life. He will wish that he had not been created and that he had never come into existence. This will be when he sees the torment of Allah and he looks at his wicked deeds that will be written down against him by the noble righteous scribes among angels. It has been said that he will only wish for that when Allah passes judgement between all of the animals that were in the worldly life. He will rectify matters between them with His just wisdom that does not wrong anyone. Even the hornless sheep will be allowed to avenge itself against the sheep with horns. Then, when the judgement between them is finished, He (Allah) will say to them (the animals), “Be dust.” So they will all become dust. Upon witnessing this the disbeliever will say, iWould that I were dust!} meaning, 1 wish I was an animal so that I would be returned to dust.’ Something of similar meaning to this has been reported in the well-known Hadith about the Siir. There are also narrations recorded from Abu Hurayrah, ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr, and others concerning this.

Surah 79: An-Naziat

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6285–6287]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat An-Naziat (Chapter - 79) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, cf 'j' & i 'jL.tj-fi- \j> lit, Ijltt tf. •>jf & kc \jff ;{v;ijitil ^ ojly f* L0'*^ »jn eft^ 41 . By those who pull out, drowning.} 42. By those who free briskly.} 43. And by the swimmers, swimming.} 44. And by the racers, racing.} 45. And by those who arrange affairs.} 46. On the Day the Rajifah shakes,} 47. Followed by the Radifah.} 43. Hearts that Day will tremble.} 49. Their vision humiliated .} 410. They say : “Shall we indeed be brought back from Al- Hdfirah?”} ill. “Even after we are bones Nakhiralt?”} 412 . They say : “It would in that case, be a return with loss!”} 413. But it will be only a single Zajrah.} 414. When behold, they are at As-Sahirah.}

Swearing by Five Characteristics that the Day of Judgement will occur Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn 'Abbas, Mas'ud, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Abu Ad-Duha and As-Suddi all said, 4fiy those who pull out, drowning. “These are the angels who remove the souls from the Children of Adam.”¹¹¹ Among them are those whose souls are removed by the angels with difficulty, as if he is being drowned during its removal. There are those people whose souls the angels remove with ease, as if they were unraveling him (i.e., his soul from him) due to their briskness. This is the meaning of Allah's statement, 4By those who free briskly. This has been mentioned by Ibn 'Abbas. ' In reference to Allah's statement, 4And by the swimmers, swimming.) Ibn Mas'ud said, “They are the angels.”¹³ Similar statements have been reported from 'Ali, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, and Abu Salih.⁴ ' Concerning Allah's statement, 4And by the racers, racing.) It has been narrated from 'Ali, Mas'ud, Mujahid, Abu Salih, and Al-Hasan Al-Basri that this means the angels.⁵ ' Then Allah says, 4:>:0 4And by those who arrange affairs.) At-Tabari 24:185, Al-Qurtubi 19:190, and Ad-Durr Al-Manth&r AMabari 24:178. ' Ad-DurrAl-Mcmthur8 :404 At-Jabari 24 :190 , and Al-Qurtubi 19 :193 ' Al-Qurtubi 19 :93 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :404.

342Surah 79. An-Nazi'at (1-14) (Part-30) 'Ali, Mujahid, 'Ata', Abu Salih, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl* bin Anas, and As-Suddi all said, “They are the angels.” * Al- Hasan added, “They control the affairs from the heaven to the earth, meaning by the command of their Lord, the Mighty and Majestic.”

The Description of the Day of Judgement, the People,

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and what They will say Then Allah says, iOn the Day the Rajifah shakes, followed by the Radifah.} Ibn 'Abbas said, “These are the two blasts (of the Trumpet) - the first and the second.”*² * Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and others have made similar statements.*³ * It has been reported from

Mujahid that he said, “In reference to the first, it is the statement of Allah, *On the Day the earth and the mountains shake.*” This is similar to Allah’s statement, *On the Day the earth and the mountains shake.* (73:14) The second is Ar-Radifah, and it is like the Allah’s statement, *And the earth and mountains shall be removed from their places, and crushed with a single crushing.* (69: 14)”⁴ Concerning Allah’s statement, *Hearts that Day will tremble.* Ibn ‘Abbas said, “This means in At-Tabari 24:190, Al-Qurtubi 19:194, and Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8:403-405.. ’ At-Tabari 24:191. ’ At-Tabari 24 :19 1 , 192 ’ At-Tabari 24:192.

afraid.” Mujahid and Qatadah also said this.² *Their vision humiliated.* meaning, the eyes of the people. It means that the eyes will be lowly and disgraced from what they will witness of terrors. Allah then says, *They say : "Shall we indeed be brought back from Al-Hafirah?"* meaning, the idolators of the Quraysh and whoever rejects the Hereafter as they did. They consider the occurrence of the resurrection after being placed in Al-Hafirah - which are the graves - as something farfetched. This has been said by Mujahid.³¹ They feel that this is something impossible after the destruction of their physical bodies and the disintegration of their bones and their decaying. Thus, Allah says, *Even after we are bones Nakhirah?* It has also been recited: (Nakhirah) Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah, all said, “This means decayed.”⁴¹ Ibn ‘Abbas said, “It is the bone when it has decayed and air enters into it.” Concerning their saying, *It would in that case be a return with loss.* (79:12) Muhammad bin Ka*b said that the Quraysh said, “If Allah brings us back to life after we die, then surely we will be losers.”¹⁵¹ Allah then says, *At-Tabari 24:193. 121 At-Tabari 24 :193 , Al-Baghawi 4 :443 131 At-Tabari 24:195. |4> At-Tabari 24:195. |5) Al-Qurtubi 19:198.*

³⁴³Surah 79. An-Nadzi'at (1-14) (Part-30) ⁴But it will be only a single Zajrah. When behold, they are at As-Sahirah .} meaning, this is a matter that is from Allah that will not occur twice, nor will there be any opportunity to affirm it or verify it. The people will be standing and looking. This will be when Allah commands the angel Israfil to blow into the Stir, which will be the blowing of the resurrection. At that time the first people and the last people will all be standing before their Lord looking. This is as Allah says, *On the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed but a little while!* (17:52) Allah has also said, *And our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.* (54:50) Allah also says, *And the matter of the Hour is not but as a twinkling of the eye, or even nearer.* (16:77) Allah then says, *When behold, they are at As-Sahirah.* Ibn ‘Abbas said, “As- Sahirah means the entire earth.”¹¹¹ Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Abu Salih have all said this as well. Hcrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, and Ibn Zayd have all said, “As-Sahirah means the face of the earth.”¹²¹ Mujahid said, “They will be at its (the earth’s) lowest part, and they will be brought out to highest part.”Then he said, “ As-Sahirah is a level place.”¹³¹ Ar-RabT bin Anas said, in At-Tabari 24:198. At-Tabari 24:198. 131 At-Tabari 24 :198 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :408

⁴When behold, they are at As-Sahirah .} “Allah says, *On the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens, and they will appear before Allah, the One, the Irresistible .* (14:48) and He says, *My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust. Then He shall leave them as a level smooth plain.You will see therein nothing crooked or curved.*

(20:105-107) and Allah says, 4 'if? o#t Jjj jllh >yj} 4And the Day We shall cause the mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a leveled plain .} (18:47) and the earth will be brought forth which will have mountains upon it, and it will not be considered from this earth (of this life). It will be an earth that no sin will be performed on it, nor will any blood be shed upon it." C'V /i) <j) «£4ilf a'jil A»k i) li JI «4i4» J 3 j* ja ii@& at 33 % tf ju <§)*& ? jgs^; A 4'i <1k il5. Has there come to you the story of Musa?} 416. When his Lord called him in the holy valley of Tuwd,} 417. Go to Fir'awn; verily, he has transgressed all bounds.} 418. And say to him : "Would you purify yourself."} 419. "And that I guide you to your Lord, so you should fear

345 Surah 79. An-Ndizi'dt (15-26) (Part-30) Him?") 420. Then he showed him the great sign.) 421 . But he denied and disobeyed.) 422. Then he turned back, striving.) 423. So he gathered and called out,) 424. Saying: "I am your lord, most high.") 425. So Allah seized him with punishing example for the Hereafter and the first (life.) 426. In this is a lesson for whoever fears.) Mentioning the Story of Musa and that it is a Lesson for Those Who fear Allah informs His Messenger Muhammad about His Messenger Musa. He mentions that he sent Musa to Fir'awn and He aided him with miracles. Yet, even after this, Fir'awn continued in his disbelief and transgression until Allah seized him with a mighty and powerful punishment. Thus is the punishment of whoever opposes you (Muhammad jg) and rejects that which you have been sent with. This is why Allah says at the end of the story, 4In this is a Lesson for whoever fears.) Allah begins by saying, 4Has there come to you the story of Musa?) meaning, have you heard of his story? 4VWhen his Lord called him) meaning, He called out speaking to him. 4cr2ii fji) 4in the holy valley) meaning purified 4Tuwa) According to what is correct, it is the name of a valley.

as preceded in Surah Ta Ha. So, He said to him: A\ ji <(Go to Fir'awn; verily, he has transgressed all bounds.} meaning, he has become haughty, rebellious and arrogant. }And say to him : "Would you purify yourself"} meaning, say to him, "Will you respond to the path and way that will purify you?" This means, Svill you submit (accept Islam) and be obedient?' d> 4And that I guide to your Lord,} meaning, 1 will guide you to the worship of your Lord.' iso that you fear} meaning, 'so that your heart will become humble, obedient, and submissive to Him after it was hard, evil, and far away from goodness.' 3ri i\$} iThen he showed him the great sign.} This means that Musa showed him - along with this truthful call - a strong evidence and a clear proof of the truthfulness of what he had come up with from Allah. iBut he denied and disobeyed.} meaning, he (Fir'awn) rejected the truth and opposed what Mtsa commanded him with of obedience. So what happened with him was that his heart disbelieved, and Musa (i.e., his call) could not internally or externally affect it. Along with this, his knowledge that what Musa had come to him with was the truth, did not necessitate his being a believer in it. This is because recognition is the knowledge of the heart, and faith is its action. And it (faith) is to comply with the truth and submit to it. Concerning Allah's statement, it ^ 'b

AThen he turned back, striving meaning, in responding to the truth with falsehood. This was by his gathering the group of magicians in order to confront that which Musa had come up with of spectacular miracles. 4So he gathered (his people) and called out meaning, among his people. ASaying; I am your lord, most high."} Ibn 'Abbas and Mujahid both said, "This is the word which Fir'awn said after he said, 4"—£** it C} i'l have not known of any other god for you all other than me} for the past forty years.' ",1) Allah then says, iSo Allah seized him with a punishing example for the Hereafter and

thefirst (life).} meaning, Allah avenged Himself against him with a severe vengeance, and He made an example and admonition of him for those rebellious people in the world who are like him. jifi Jia 'fyj} AAnd on the Day of Resurrection, evil indeed is the gift gifted [i.e., the curse (in this world) pursued by another curse (in this world) pursued by another curse (in the Hereafter)].} (1 1:99) This is as Allah says, AAnd We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day ofResurrection, they will not be helped.} (28:41) Allah said; A 4 \y 11) Al-Qurtubi 19:202.

rJl am «A1 smm ji* dJ&ig&S. &i[4In this is a lesson far whoeverfears.} ;g;i&; fcit j 6E lit £t:> tf? iut; <?£.\$ tlij'j mi fg lire ^ gy rpWi-jt 3Ci'j 4tfi.'-f4^i} |3 C£ 427. Are you more difficult to create or is the heaven that He constructed?} 428. He raised its hei- ght,andhasperfectedit.} 429. Its night He covers and He brings out its forenoon.} 430. And after that He spread the earth,} 431. And brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture.} 432. And the mountains He hasfixedfirmly,} 433. As provision and benefitfar you and your cattle.} Creating the Heavens and the Earth is more difficult than repeating Creation in refutation of the claim rejecting resurrection due to the renewal of creation after its original state, Allah says; 4Are you} 'O people' itei j fit&} 4more difficult to create or is the heaven...?} meaning, 'rather the heaven is more difficult to create than <£*-><*jS® j\$T ylit Jib CljffJ (JjUdU cS ,Xi - "'\i <>' "'eva?*, . wiisii 35

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iAnd after that He spread the earth,} He explains this statement by the statement that follows it, iAnd brought forth therefrom its water and its pasture.} It already has been mentioned previously in Surat Ha Mim As- Sajdah111 that the earth was created before the heaven was created, but it was only spread out after the creation of the heaven. This means that He brought out what was in it with a forceful action. This is the meaning of what was said by Ibn 'Abbas and others, and it was the explanation preferred by Ibn Jarir.12 ! In reference to the statement of Allah, iAnd the mountains He has fixed firmly,} meaning, He settled them, made them firm, and established them in their places. And He is the Mbst Wise, the All-Knowing. He is Most Kind to His creation, Most Merciful. Allah then says, <&&&& 4As provision and benefitfor you and your cattle.} meaning, He spread out the earth, caused its springs to gush forth, brought forth its hidden benefits, caused its rivers to flow, and caused its vegetation, trees, and fruits to grow. He also made its mountains firm so that it (the earth) would be calmly settled with its dwellers, and He stabilized its dwelling places. All of this is a means of beneficial enjoyment for His creatures

(mankind) providing them of what cattle they need, which they eat and ride upon. He has granted them these beneficial things for the period that they need them, in this worldly abode, until the end of time and the expiration of this life. *in* £ LJd %%£. c \$'£ g Safcf&f# uVl .fj fli* ljU. if Cij ^ See volume eight, the Tafsir of Surah Fussilat (41 :9-12). At-Tabari 24:208.

ce.d oQ iclllf 4si>)&> QfejLff^ ii' yyCJji' j*- Ijr^i \$ 'Q-jj. fi <>* %jp4vu **5> ji iS» ;1 r -1 434. But when there comes the Greatest Catastrophe 435. The Day when man shall remember what he strove for.} 436. And Hell shall be made apparent for whoever sees.} 437. Then for him who transgressed} 438. And preferred the life of this world,} 439. Verily, his abode will be the Hell;} 440. But as for him who feared standing before his Lord, and forbade himself from desire.} 441 . Verily, Paradise will be his abode.} 442 . They ask you about the Hour - when will be its appointed time?} 443. What do you have to mention of it.} 444. To your Lord it is limited.} 445. You are only a wamer for those who fear it,} 446. The Day they see it (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an ('Ashiyyah) afternoon or its (Duha) morning.} The Day of Judgement, its Pleasures and Hell, and that its Time is not known Allah says, *£ fy} 4But when there comes the Great Catastrophe} This refers to the Day of Judgement. This has been said by Ibn 'Abbas. 11 * It has been called this because it will overcome every matter. It will be frightful and horrifying. As Allah says, <&1 %X%} 4And the Hour will be more grievous and more bitter.} m At-Jabari 24 :2 1 1

(54:46) Then Allah says, 4t iThe Day when man shall remember what he strove for meaning, at that time the Son of Adam will reflect upon all of his deeds, both the good and the evil. This is as Allah says, ^ o£ \$"" 4On the Day will man remember, but how will that remembrance avail him?} (89:23) Then Allah says, iAnd Hell shall be made apparent for whoever sees.} meaning, it will become apparent for the onlookers, so the people will see it with their own eyes. iTlten for him who transgressed} meaning, who rebels and behaves arrogantly. \tPy& iAnd preferred the life of this world,} meaning, he gives it precedence over the matters of his religion and his Hereafter. i\$:z}3 j> %} iVerily his abode will be the Hell;} meaning, his final destination will be Hell, his food will be from the tree of Zaqqum, and his drink will be from Hamlm. X if & "by iBut as for him who feared standing before his Lord and forbade himself from desire.} meaning, he fears the standing before Allah, he fears Allah's judgement of him, he prevents his soul from following its desires, and he compels it to obey its Master.

353 Surah 79. An-Nazi'dt (34-46) (Part-30) \$Verily Paradise will be his abode. meaning, his final abode, his destination, and his place of return will be the spacious Paradise. Then Allah says, oQ £ &\$&} iThey ask you about the Hour - when will be its appointed time? What do you have to mention of it. To your Lord it is limited. meaning, its knowledge is not with you, nor with any creature. Rather the knowledge of it is with Allah. He is the One Who knows the exact time of its occurrence. j; tfJE*% y && v iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden . They ask you as if you have a good knowledge of it. Say: "The knowledge thereof is with Allah."} (7:187) Allah says here, 4To your Lord it is limited.} Thus, when Jibril asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the time of the last Hour he said, "The one questioned about it knows no more than the questioner, n Allah said, *&a 4You are only a wamer for those who fear it,} meaning, 'I sent you to warn mankind and caution them to beware of the torment and punishment of Allah. So whoever fears Allah, fears stand- ing before Him, and His threat, then he will follow you, and thus be successful and

victorious. However, whoever denies you and opposes you, then he will only suffer loss and failure.’ Allah then says, 111 Fath Al-Bari 1 :140 .

The Day they see it (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an (‘Ashiyyah) afternoon or its (Duha) morning.} meaning, when they stand up from their graves to go to the place of Gathering, they will feel that the period of the worldly life was short, it will seem to them that it was only the afternoon of one day. Juwaybir reported from Ad-Dahhak from Ibn ‘Abbas: {The Day they see it (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an (‘Ashiyyah) afternoon or its (Duha) morning.} “As for ‘Ashiyyah, it is the time between noon until the setting of the sun. iOr its (Duha) morning} what is between sunrise and midday (noon).” Qatadah said, “This refers to the time period of the worldly life in the eyes of the people when they see the Hereafter.”

Surah 80: Abasa

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Opening

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Opening of Surah 'Abasa (Chapter - 80) Which was revealed in Makkah in the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. He frowned and turned away.} 42. Because there came to him the blind man.} 43. And how can you know that he might become pure?} 44. Or he might receive admonition, and the admonition might profit him?} 45. As for him who thinks himself self-sufficient,} 46. To him you attend; } 47. What does it matter to you if he will not become pure?} 48. But as for him who came to you running,} 49. And is afraid.} 50. Of him you are neglectful and divert your attention to another.} 51. Nay; indeed it is an admonition.} 52. So, whoever wills, let him pay attention to Him (it).} 53. In Records held in honor,} 54. Exalted, purified.} 55. In the hands of ambassadors (Safarah),} 56. Honorable and obedient.} The Prophet being reprimanded because He frowned at a Weak Man More than one of the scholars of Tafsir mentioned that one day the Messenger of Allah was addressing one of the great leaders of the Quraysh while hoping that he would accept Islam. While he was speaking in direct conversation with him, Ibn Umm Maktam came to him, and he was of those who had accepted Islam in its earliest days. He (Ibn Umm Maktam) then began asking the Messenger of Allah about something, urgently beseeching him. The Prophet hoped that the man would be guided, so he asked Ibn Umm Maktam to wait for a moment so he could complete his conversation. He frowned in the face of Ibn Umm Maktam and turned away from him in order to face the other man. Thus, Allah revealed, 'He frowned and turned away. Because there came to him the blind man. And how can you know that he might become pure?' meaning, he may attain purification and cleanliness in his soul. Or he might receive admonition, and the admonition might profit him?}

47 . What does it matter to you if he will not become pure?} 48. But as for him who came to you running,} 49. And is afraid.} 50. Of him you are neglectful and divert your attention to another.} 51. Nay; indeed it is an admonition.} 52. So, whoever wills, let him pay attention to Him (it).} 53. In Records held in honor,} 54. Exalted, purified.} 55. In the hands of ambassadors (Safarah),} 56. Honorable and obedient.} The Prophet being reprimanded because He frowned at a Weak Man More than one of the scholars of Tafsir mentioned that one day the Messenger of Allah was addressing one of the great leaders of the Quraysh while hoping that he would accept Islam. While he was speaking in direct conversation with him, Ibn Umm Maktam came to him, and he was of those who had accepted Islam in its earliest days. He (Ibn Umm Maktam) then began asking the Messenger of Allah about something, urgently beseeching him. The Prophet hoped that the man would be guided, so he asked Ibn Umm Maktam to wait for a moment so he could complete his conversation. He frowned in the face of Ibn Umm Maktam and turned away from him in order to face the other man. Thus, Allah revealed, 'He frowned and turned away. Because there came to him the blind man. And how can you know that he might become pure?' meaning, he may attain purification and cleanliness in his soul. Or he might receive admonition, and the admonition might profit him?}

Surah 80. 'Abasa (1-16) (Part-30) meaning, he may receive admonition and abstain from the forbidden. 4-As for him who thinks himself self-sufficient. To him you attend meaning, "you face the rich person so that perhaps he may be guided." What does it matter to you if he will not become pure? meaning, "you are not responsible for him if he does not attain purification." But as for him who came to you running. And is afraid. meaning, he is seeking you and he comes to you so that he may be guided by what you say to him.' Of him you are neglectful and divert your attention to another. meaning, 'you are too busy.' Here Allah commands His Messenger to not single anyone out with the warning. Rather, he should equal warn the noble and the weak, the poor and the rich, the master and the slave, the men and the women, the young and the old. Then Allah will guide whomever He chooses to a

path that is straight. He has the profound wisdom and the decisive proof. Abu Yala and Ibn Jarir both recorded from 'A'ishah that she said about, \$He frowned and turned away "This was revealed about Ibn Umm Maktum, the blind man. He came to the Messenger of Allah 2g and began saying, 'Guide me.' At the time the Messenger of Allah jg had a man with him who was one of the great leaders of the idolators. So the Prophet jg turned away fromhim (IbnUmm Maktum) and faced the othermanand said.

359Surah 80. 'Abasa (1-16) (Part-30) iexalted^ meaning, elevated in status. ipurified^ meaning, from impurity, additions and deficiency. Concerning Allah's statement, iln the hands ofambassadors (Safarah,)) Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, and Ibn Zayd, all said, "These are the angels." Al-Bukhari said, "Safarah (ambassadors) refers to the angels. They travel around rectifying matters between themselves. The angelswhen they descend with the revelation ofAllah, bringing it like the ambassadorwho rectifies matters between people."*2 Allah said, i.%fu 4Honorable and obedient.) meaning, they are noble, handsome, and honorable in their creation. Their character and their deeds are righteous, pure and perfect. Here it should be noted that it is necessary for one who carries the Qur'an (i.e., the angel) to be following righteousness and guidance Imam Ahmad recorded from 'A'ishah that the Messenger of Allah jg said. J ^ ^ j 4 4 p *~ t * S 4-1p jAj 5J^?*** f ^** t 4j y* la ysj jlJcb l \yj 'He who recites the Qur'an proficiently, will be with the noble, righteous, ambassador angels, and the one who recites it with difficulty will receive two rewards . »*3 This Hadith was reported by the group.*4 *] * At-Tabari 24 :221 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :418. * FathAl-Bdri 8:561. * Ahmad 6 :48 * Path Al-Bari 8:560, Muslim 1 :549, Abu Dfiwud 2:148, Tuhfat Al- Ahwadhi 8:215, An-Nasat in Al-Kubra. 6:506, and Ibn Majah

4f/trk ip* p /& Oi J; \$ & <\$2l\$ C dl j— 6 uj" ui \$> as. uj Jr ^ft£ju4i JiU ^ Q\$:|:C3j Cy :\$& & £\$ 3M az. ? stc a ^^ 5||}&i> iJ0i Qi/fi/a mankind! How ungrateful he is!} 418. From what thing did He create him?} 419. From a Nutfah He created him and then set him in due proportion.} 420. Then He made the path easyfor him.} 421 . Then He causes him to die and puts him in his grave.} 422. Then when it is His will, He will resurrect him.} 423. Nay, but has not done what He commanded hitn.} 424. Then let man look at hisfood:}. 425. We pourforth water in abundance.} 426. And We split the earth in clefts.} 427. And We cause therein Habb to grow,} 428. And grapes and Qadb,} 429. And olives and date palms,} 430. And Ghulb Hadd'iq,} 431 . Andfruits (Fakihah) and herbage (Abb).} 432. A provision and benefitfor you and your cattle.} The Refutation againstWhoever denies Life after Death Allah rebukes those who deny the Resurrection and the Final Gathering. 4Qutila mankind!} Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, 4Qutila mankind!} "May man be cursed." * Abu Malik also HI Al-Qurtubi 19:217.

361Siirah 80. 'Abasa (17-32) (Part-30) made a similar statement. He said, "This refers to the rejecting type of man, due to his abundant denial without any support- ing argument. Rather he denies simply because he thinks it is farfetched and because he lacks knowledge of it." Ibn Jurayj said, 4How ungrateful he is!} "This means none is worse in disbelief than he is." Qatadah said, &t} iHow ungrateful lie is!} "This means none is more cursed than he is." 1 ! Then Allah explains how He created him from something despised and that He is able to bring him back to life just as He created him initially. Allah says, KV. -i: • V 4From what thing did He create him? From a Nutfah He created him, and then set him in due proportion.} meaning, He decreed his life span, his sustenance, his deeds, and

whether he would be miserable or happy. iTheti He made the path easy for him.} Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “Then He made his coming out of his mother’s belly easy for him.”*2 This was also said by Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Abu Salih, Qatadah, As-Suddi, and it was the explanation preferred by Ibn Jarir.*3 Mujahid said, “This is similar to Allah’s statement, 4Verily, We guided him on the path, he is either grateful or ungrateful.} (76:3) meaning, We explained it to him, clarified it, and made it easy for him to act upon.” Al-Hasan and Ibn Zayd both said the *** Al-Baghawi 4 :448 At-Tabari 24:223. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8:419, 223, 224.

363Surah 80. ‘Abasa (17-32) (Part-30 }But he has not done what He commanded him.} Allah is saying that man has not fulfilled for his Lord the obligations that were imposed upon him.” What seems apparent to me of its actual meaning - and Allah knows best - is that the Ayah & *1 ft iThen when it is His will, He will resurrect him.} means, He will resurrect him. iNay! But he has not done what He commanded him.} means. He has not done it (resurrected them) as of yet, until the time period has expired and the extent of the earthly life of humanity is complete, according to the lives of all whom Allah has written it to exist from the time they are brought into existence into the world. Verily, Allah has decreed the existence of mankind, and its duration, therefore, when that is finished with Allah, He resurrects the creatures and repeats their creation just as He initially created them. The Growth of the Seed and Other Things is a Proof of Life after Peath iThen let man look at his food} This is a call to reflect upon Allah’s favor. It also contains an evidence in the vegetation’s coming to life from the lifeless earth, that the bodies can be brought to life after being decayed bones and scattered dust. at i\} iWe pour forth water in abundance.} meaning, We sent it down from the sky to the earth.’ £2. ?} }And We split the earth in clefts.} meaning, *We cause it (the water) to settle in it (the earth), and it enters into its boundaries, and mingles with the parts of the seeds that are left in the earth. From this the seeds grow, rise up and appear m At-Tabari 24 :225

on the surface of the earth (in the form ofvegetation).’ iAnd Mfe cause therein Habb to grow. And grapes and Qadb,} Al-Habb refers to all types of seeds (or grains). Grapes are well- known. Al-Qadb are the moist (green) herbal plants that animals graze on. It is also called Al-Qat. Ibn ‘Abbas, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and As-Suddi, all said thisJ Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “Al-Qadb is fodder.” iAnd olives} It is well-known, and it is a food just as its juice is a food. It is eaten for breakfast and used as an oil. i#%} 4And date palms,} It (i.e., its fruit) is eaten as Balah, Busr, Rutab and Tamr, Niya’ and Matbukh, all of which are varieties of dates that range from unripe, ripe and dried in their textures. Its juice is also extracted to make pulpy fruit drinks and vinegar. iAnd Ghulb Hada’iq,} meaning, gardens. Al-Hasan and Qatadah both said, “Ghulb are gardens of date palms that are thick and handsome.”*21 Ibn ‘Abbas and Mujahid both said, “It means everything that is gathered and collected.”131 Allah said, iAnd fruits (Fakihah) and herbage (Abb).} Fakihah includes every type of fruit. Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Al-Fakihah is everything that is eaten ripe, and Al-Abb is what the earth grows that is eaten by grazing animals and not people.”*41 In one narration reported from him he said, “It is the grass for the livestock animals. , 5) At-Jabari 24:226. At-Jabari 24 :228,421. At-Jabari 24 :227 At-Tabari 24 :230, 231 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :42 1

365Surah 80. ‘Abasa (17-32) (Part-30 Abu TJbayd Al-Qasim bin Sallam reported from Ibrahim At-Taymi that he said, “Abu Bakr As-Siddlq was asked about Allah’s statement, 4And fruits (Fakihah) and

herbage (Abb.) and he said, 'What sky would shade me and what earth would carry me if I said about the Book of Allah that which I did not have knowledge of.' "[1] In reference to what Ibn Jarir recorded from Anas, that he said, "Umar bin Al-Khattab recited 4Hefrowned and turned away.) then when he reached this Ayah 4And fruits (Fakihah) and herbage (Abb.) he said, 'We already know what Al-Fakihah is, but what is Al-Abb?' Then he said, "By your life, O Ibn Al-Khattab, this is something overburden- some (i.e., unnecessary to ask about).' "2) This report has an authentic chain of narration. More than one person has narrated it from Anas. The meaning of the narration is that 'Umar wanted to know how it looks, its type and its exact description, because he ('Umar) and everyone who reads this Ayah knows that it is one of the plants that grows from the earth. This is clear due to the Allah's saying, 4And We cause therein the Habb to grow. And grapes and Qadb, and olives and date palms. And Ghulb Hada'iq. And fruits (Fakihah) and herbage (Abb.) And then He says, 4A provision and benefit for you and your cattle.) meaning, a means of livelihood for you all and your cattle in l 1 * Al-Baghawi 4 :449 At-Tabari 24:229.

367 Surah 80. 'Abasa (33-42) (Part-30) to get away from them because horror will be so great and the matter will be so weighty. There is an authentic Hadith related concerning the intercession that states that every one of the great Messengers of firm resolve will be requested to intercede with Allah on behalf of the creation, but each of them will say, "O myself! O myself! Today I will not ask You (O Allah) concerning anyone but myself." Even 'Isa bin Maryam will say, "I will not ask Him (Allah) concerning anyone but myself today. I will not even ask Maryam, the woman who gave birth to me." 1 11 Thus, Allah says, iThat Day shall a man flee from his brother, and from his mother and his father, and from his wife and his children.} Qatadah said, "The most beloved and then the next most beloved, and the closest of kin and then the next closest of kin - due to the terror of that Day." Allah said, ^ rri && iEvery man that Day will have enough to make him careless of others.} meaning, he will be preoccupied in his business and distracted from the affairs of others. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger of Allah said, jf. i\ ali> jj «Yo« will all be gathered barefoot, naked, walking and uncircumcised .» So his wife said, "O Messenger of Allah! Will we look at or see each other's nakedness?" The Prophet jg replied, aJU-II li — : Jli j\ — jli j~, 'y. JIS «Every man among them on that Day will have enough (worries) to make him careless of others* - or he said: they will be too busy to look.*^ 111 Muslim 1 :182. Al-Hakim 2 :251 . Similar with Al-Bukhari no. 6162

Ibn 'Abbas narrated that the Prophet 5^5 said, Si'ji- «U>- j "You will all be gathered barefoot, naked and uncircumcised .» So a woman said, "Will we see or look at each other's nakedness?" He replied, i j~*y. p-f-; f \ Ij» "O so-and-so woman! Every man among them on that Day will have enough (worries) to make him careless of others . At-Tirmidhi said, "This Hadith is Hasan Sahth.'^ 1 ^ The Faces of the People of Paradise and the People of the Fire on the Day of Judgement Allah says; 'Jr* tt* 'X-j iSotne faces that Day will be bright (Musfirah), laughing, rejoicing at good news> meaning, the people will be divided into two parties. There will be faces that are Musfirah, which means bright. 4Laughing, rejoicing at good news .^ meaning, happy and pleased due to the joy that will be in their hearts. The good news will be apparent on their faces. These will be the people of Paradise. o*w lex yfjor 4And other faces that Day will be dust-stained. Darkness (Qatarah) will cover them meaning, they will be overcome and covered with Qatarah, which is darkness. Ibn 'Abbas said, iDarkness (Qatarah) will cover themf "This means that they (the faces) will be overcome with m TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :251

369Siirah 80. 'Abasa (33-42) (Part-30) darkness."111 Allah said, 4.Such will be the disbelieving, the wicked evildoers.} meaning, they are disbelievers in their hearts, evildoers in their actions. This is as Allah says, 4And they will beget none but wicked disbelievers.} (71:27) This is the end of the Tafsvr of Surat 'Abasa, and to Allah all praise and thanks are due. 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthdr8 :424 .

Surah 81: At-Takwir

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The Tafsir of Surat At-Takwir

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6316–6319]

(Chapter - 81) Which was revealed in Mafchah What has been narrated about This Surah Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn “Umar that the Messenger of Allah said, J UQJ! f>: ^p ’j&\ j \l[] <*Whoever wishes to look at the Day of Judgement as if he is seeing it with his own eyes, then let him read, 4When the sun is wound round. (81:1) and; 4When the heaven is cleft asunder.} (82:1) and; 4When the heaven is split asunder.} (84:1)»m Likewise, At-Tirmidhi has also recorded this HadithJ2' In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful 0ZZZ lEi\ f# % %S\ J^ir 5r*I ,3 i5 \$\$<£\$ y* **AP' til ft# 41. When the sun is Kuwwirat.} 42. And when the stars Inkadarat.} ^3. And when the mountains are made to pass away;} 44. And when the pregnant she-camels are neglected;} m Ahmad 2:27. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:252.

371 Surah 81 . At-Takwir (1-14) (Part-30 45. And when the wild beasts are gathered together> 46. And when the seas become as blazing fire.} 47. And when the souls are joined with their mates.} 48. And when the female infant (Al-Maw'udah) buried alive is questioned (Su'ilat):} 49. For what sin was she killed?} 410. And when the pages are laid open.} 411 . And when the heaven is Kushitat;} 412. And when Hell is Su'irat.} 413. And when Paradise is brought near.} 414. Every person will know what he has brought.} What will happen on the Day of Judgement, and that is the rolling up of the Sun 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas: 4When the sun is Kuunvirat.} “This means it will be darkened.” 11 Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas; “It will go away.” Qatadah said, “Its light will go away.”*21 Said bin Jubayr said, “Kuwwirat means it will sink in.”*3 ' Abu Salih said, “Kuwwirat means it will be thrown down.” At-Takwir means to gather one part of something with another part of it (i.e., folding). From it comes the folding of the turban (7mamah) and the folding of clothes together. Thus, the meaning of Allah’s statement, <45\$> 4Kuwwirat} is that part of it will be folded up into another part of it. Then it will be rolled up and thrown away. When this is done to it, its light will go away. Al-Bukhari recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg said, * l > At-Tabari 24 :237 ' At-Tabari 24:238. ' At-Tabari 24:238.

372 TafsTr Ibn Kathlr •yuaii “The sun and the moon will be rolled up on the Day of Judgement .n 1 * 1 Al-Bukhari was alone in recording this Hadith and this is his wording of it. Dispersing the Stars 4,^0^ fy3\ iAnd when the stars Inkadarat> meaning, when they are scattered. This is as Allah says, itgcgs 4#ji iAnd when the stars have fallen and scattered> (82:2) The basis of the word Inkidar is Insib&b, which means to be poured out. Ar-Rabr bin Anas reported from Abu Al-‘Aliyah, who reported from Ubayy bin Ka'b that he said, “Six signs will take place before the Day of Judgement. The people will be in their marketplaces when the sun’s light will go away. When they are in that situation, the stars will be

scattered. When they are in that situation, the mountains will fall down upon the face of the earth, and the earth will move, quake and be in a state of mixed up confusion. So the Jinns will then flee in fright to the humans and the humans will flee to the Jinns. The domestic beasts, birds and wild animals will mix together, and they will surge together in a wave (of chaos). 4 • rs»- iAnd when the wild beasts are gathered together. This means they will be mixed. 4\$^ ju-K <>0 iAnd when the pregnant she camels are neglected;} This means their owners will neglect them. 4dfeiXX nr Fath Al-BOri 6 :343

373 Surah 81 . At-Takwlr (1-14) (Part-30) 4And when the seas become as blazing fire}” Then he (Ubayy) went on to say, “The Jinns will say, *We come to you with news.’ So they will all go to the sea, and it will be a blazing fire. While they are in that state, the earth will be split with one huge crack that will extend from the lowest, seventh earth to the highest, seventh heaven. So while they are in that state, a wind will come that will kill all of them.” Ibn Jarir recorded this narration with this wording. Moving of the Mountains, abandoning of the Pregnant She-Camels, and the gathering of the Wild Beasts Concerning Allah’s statement, top tfr iAnd when the mountains are made to pass away;} meaning, they will not remain in their places and they will be destroyed. Then the earth will be left as a flat, level plain. Then Allah says, i&z iAnd when the pregnant she-camels (’Ishar) are neglected (’Uttilat) ;} ‘Ikrimah and Mujahid said, “Ishar are (pregnant she-) camels.”*2 ’ Mujahid said, “‘Uttilat means abandoned and left.”*3 * Ubayy bin Ka*b and Ad-Dahhak both said, “Their owners will neglect them.”*4 ’ Ar-RabT bin Khuthaym said, “They will not be milked or tied up. Their masters will leave them abandoned.”*5 ’ Ad-Dahhak said, “They will be left with no one to tend to them.”*6 And the meaning of all of these statements is similar.

What is intended is that the ‘Ishar is a type of camel. It is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6319–6330]

actually the best type of camel, and particularly the pregnant females of them when they have reached the tenth month of ’ At-Tabari 24:237. At-Tabari 24:240. ’ At-Tabari 24:240. ’ At-Tabari 24:240. ’ At-Tabari 24:240. ’ At-Tabari 24:240.

374 Tafsir Ibn Kathir their pregnancies. One of them is singularly referred to as ‘Ushara’, and she keeps that name until she gives birth. So the people will be too busy to tend to her, take care of her or benefit from her, after she used to be the most important thing to them. This will be due to what will suddenly overtake them of the great, terrifying and horrible situation. This is the matter of the Day of Judgement, the coming together of its causes, and the occurrence of those things that will happen before it. j-J-y iAnd when the wild beasts are gathered together.) meaning, gathered. This is as Allah says, it, jf 4 ll££» £ j£?t\$ 'tj JgjR 4& it Ji2& iThere is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are communities like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they shall be gathered.) (6:38) Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Everything will be gathered, even the flies.” This statement was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. ’ Allah also says, iAnd (so did) the birds assembled.) [38:19] meaning, gathered. The Blazing of the Seas Allah says, iAnd when the seas become as blazing fire.) Ibn Jarir recorded from Said bin Al-Musayyib that ‘Ali said to a Jewish man, “Where is the Hell?” The man said, “The sea.” ‘Ali then said, “I think he is truthful, as Allah says f&) l1 ’ Al-Qurtubi 19:229.

375 Surah 81 . At-TakwTr (1-14) (Part-30) 4And by the seas kindled (Masjiir).} (52:6) and; 4And when the seas become as blazing fire.}’1,11 This has already been discussed previously with the explanation of Allah’s statement, pf} 4And by the seas kindled (Masjiir).} (52:6)’21 Joiningthe Souls Concerning Allah’s statement, 4And when the souls are joined with their mates.} meaning, every type (of soul) will be gathered with its peer (or mate). This is as Allah says. 4It will be said to the angels) : "Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions (from the devils).} (37:22) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from An-Nu‘man bin Bashir that the Messenger of Allah said, Z £# po} :JX'&ri? 2)1 *4And When the souls are joined with their mates.} Those who are alike. Every man will be with every group of people who performed the-same deeds that he did. This is because Allah says, 4And you (all) will be in three groups. So those on the Right Hand - how (fortunate) will be those on Right Hand! And those on the Left Hand - how (unfortunate) will be those 111 At-Tabari 24:242. I2 ' See volume nine , the Tafsir of Surat At-Tur (52 :6)

on the Left Hand (56 :7-10) They are those who are alike.^ Questioning the Female InfantWho was buried Alive Allah says, iAnd when the female infant (Al-Maw'udah) buried alive is questioned: For what sin was she killed?} The majority have recited it as Su'ilat (she is questioned), as it is here. Al-Maw'udah is the female infant that the people of the pre-Islamic time of ignorance would bury in the dirt due to their hatred of girls. Therefore, on the Day of Judgement, the female infant will be asked what sin she committed that caused her to be murdered. This will be a means of frightening her murderer. For verily, if the one who was wronged is questioned, what does the wrongdoer (the one who is guilty of the oppression) think then? ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, iAnd when the female infant (Al-Maw'udah) buried alive Su'ilat:} “This means that she will ask.” Abu Ad-Duha made a similar statement when he said, “She will ask, meaning she will demand restitution for her blood.”*21 The same has been reported from As-Suddi and Qatadah. Hadiths have been reported concerning the Maw'udah. Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘A’ishah, who reported from Judamah bint Wahb, the sister of Tjkkashah, that she said, “I was in the presence of the Messenger of Allah ^ when he was with some people, and he said, Jafi p-A ‘J-Aj fJA J> A cJLLk JVilB At-Tabari 24:245. The chain for this narration is not authentic. Prior to this narration , At-Tabari recorded an authentic chain with much the same wording from Umar, may Allah be pleased with him. At-Tabari 24:246.

“/ was about to prohibit sexual relations with breast feeding women, but then I saw that the Romans and the Persians have sexual relations with their women who breastfeed their children and it does not harm the children at all.» Then they asked him about interruption of sexual intercourse to prevent the male discharge from entering the womb of the woman, and he said, 03jiyi}\ yij J «That is the minor infanticide and it is the female infant buried alive (Maw'udah) that will be questioned.s” Muslim, Ibn Majah, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal, all recorded this Hadith as well. The Atonement for burying Infant Girls Alive ‘Abdur-Razzaq said that IsraU informed them from Simak bin Harb, from An-Nu‘man bin Bashir, who reported from Umar bin Al-Khattab that he said concerning Allah’s statement, fc.sirv0 4And when the female infant buried alive is questioned.} “Qays bin ‘Asim came to the Messenger of Allah and said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Verily, I buried some daughters of mine alive in the period of pre-Islamic ignorance.’ The Messenger of Allah jg said, "Vj J* o* Jr*” “Free a slave for each one of them .» Then Qays said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Verily, I am an owner of camels.’ The Prophet jfe, said, J* If “77ien sacrifice a camel for each one of them ” Ahmad 6:434. ^ Muslim 2:1066,

1067, Ibn M&jah 1:648, Abu Dawud 3:211, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi6 :249 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:106. 131 'Abdur-Razzaq 3:351.

The Distribution of the Pages Allah says, i&'krZ 4. And when the pages are laid open> Ad-Dahhak said, "Every person will be given his paper in his right hand or in his left hand." Qatadah said, "O Son of Adam ! It (your paper) is written in, then it is rolled up, then it will be distributed to you on the Day of Judgement. So let each man look at what he himself dictated to be written in his paper." Removing the Heavens, kindling Hellfire, and Paradise being brought near Allah says, iAtid when the heaven is Kushitat;} Mujahid said, "It draws away." 12' As-Suddi said, "Stripped off." Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd when Hell is Su'irat.} As-Suddi said, "It is heated." In reference to Allah's statement, iAnd when Paradise is brought near> Ad-Dahhak, Abu Malik, Qatadah, and Ar-Rabi' bin Khuthajmi, all said, "This means it will be brought near to its inhabitants." Everyone will know what He has brought on the Day of Judgement Concerning Allah's statement, iEvery person will blow what he has brought.} This is the conclusive response of the previous statements, 111 At-Tabari 24:249. 121 At-Tabari 24:249.

Jr 0A1 c&j. mm>~s*meaning at the time these matters occur, every soul will know what it has done, and that will be brought forth for it, as Allah says, ilXft. li u^u J^=> AmI fji) : < ' i" 5 '& v • o j • - • ?* "J yy- 0; Die*" l"." ?f -t 4" -ATAiJJ l |*b jl y, iy <*y« ^On the Day when every person will be confronted with all the good he has done, and all the evil he has done, he will wish that there were a great distance between him and his evil.) (3:30) Allah also says, P» % & W 40n that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind.) (75:13) & Al ^cr*5 6) gp>5 (i) J0 'tpiJify X*>) Qi&Zz Cj f gt£ &m & & \$ #• &t 2 G if)^ ySPJ^G t2^if ^Vc fcj a; .TiJ J uj<L3 Uj ..!*(Ci*-i J JJJ j\i>U yj ji jj 4>j 415. But nay! I swear by Al-Khunnas.) 416. Al-Jawdr Al-Kunnas.) i!7. And by the night when it 'As'as.)

418. And by the day when it Tanaffas . 419. Verily , this is the Word a most honorable messenger. 420. Dhi Quwwah, with the Lord of the Throne - Making 421. Obeyed there, trustworthy.4 422. And your companion is not a madman. 423. And indeed he saw him in the clear horizon. 424. And he withholds not a knowledge of the Unseen. 425. And it is not the word of the outcast Shaytan.4 426. Then where are you going?4 427. Verily, this is no less than a Reminder for the creatures. 428. To whomsoever among you who wills to walk straight. 429. And you cannot will unless that Allah wills - the Lord of all that exists .

The Explanation of the Words Al-Khunnas and Al- Kurinas Muslim recorded in his Sahuhi, and An-Nasal in his Book of Tafsir, in explaining this Ayah, from 'Amr bin Hurayth that he said, "I prayed the Morning prayer behind the Prophet sfe, and I heard him reciting, 4But nay! I swear by Al-Khunnas, Al-Jawar Al-Kunnas, and by the night when it 'As'as, and by the day when it Tanaffas .4^ Ibn Jarir recorded from Khalid bin 'Ar'arah that he heard 'Ali being asked about the Ayah; pf i) (Nay! I swear by Al-Khunnas, Al-Jawdr Al-Kunnas.) and he said, "These are the stars that withdraw (disappear) during the day and sweep across the sky (appear) at night."*21 Concerning Allah's statement, * l * Muslim 1 : 336, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :507 At-Tabari 24:251.

<sj\$} iAnd by the night when it 'As'as.} There are two opinions about this statement. One of them is that this refers to its advancing with its darkness. Mujahid said, "It means its darkening." Said bin

Jubayr said, “When it begins.” Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “When it covers the people.”¹¹¹ This was also said by ‘Atiyah Al- ‘Awfi¹²¹ ‘Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al-‘Awfi both reported from Ibn ‘Abbas: {fy} iwlten it 'As'as} “This means when it goes away.”¹³¹ Mujahid, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak, all said the same.¹⁴¹ Zayd bin Aslam and his son ‘Abdur-Rahman also made a similar statement, when they said, iivhen it 'As'as} “This means when it leaves, and thus it turns away.”¹⁵¹ I believe that the intent in Allah’s saying, iwhen it ‘As'as} is when it approaches, even though it is correct to use this word for departing also. However, approachment is a more suitable usage here. It is as if Allah is swearing by the night and its darkness when it approaches, and by the morning and its light when it shines from the east. This is as Allah says, iBy the night as it envelops. By the day as it appears in brightness} (92: 1-2) and He also says, At-Jabari 24:256. At-Tabari 24:256. At-Tabari 24:255. At-Tabari 24:256. At-Tabari 24:256.

iBy the forenoon. By the night when it darkens. (93:1-2) Allah also says, iCleave of the daybreak. He has appointed night for resting.> (6:96) And there are other similar Ayat that mention this. Many of the scholars of the fundamentals of language have said that the word ‘As'as is used to mean advancing and retreating, with both meanings sharing the same word. Therefore, it is correct that the intent could be both of them, and Allah knows best. Concerning Allah’s statement, iAtid by the day when it Tanaffas.} Ad-Dahhak said, “When it rises.” Qatadah said, “When it brightens and advances.”¹¹¹ Jibril descended with the Qur’an and it is not the result of insanity Concerning Allah’s statement, 4Verily, this is the Word of a most honorable messenger.} meaning, indeed this Qur’an is being conveyed by a noble messenger, which is referring to an honorable angel, who has good character and a radiant appearance, and he is Jibril. Ibn ‘Abbas, Ash-Sha’bi, Maymun bin Mihran, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabi’ bin Anas, Ad-Dahhak and others have said this.² iDhi Quwwah} This is similar to Allah’s statement, ijfc 111 At-Jabari 24:258. ‘Al-Qurtubi 19 :240 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :433

383 Surah 81. At-Takwir (15-29) (Part-30) 4He has been taught by one mighty in power, Dhu Mirrah.} (53:5-6) meaning, mighty in creation, mighty in strength and mighty in actions. iwith the Lord of the Throne - Making meaning, he has high status and lofty rank with Allah. iObeyed there, meaning, he has prestige, his word is listened to, and he is obeyed among the most high gathering (of angels). Qatadah said, . 4? 4Obeyed there^ “This means in the heavens. He is not one of the lower ranking (ordinary) angels. Rather he is from the high ranking, prestigious angels. He is respected and has been chosen for (the delivery of) this magnificent Message.” Allah then says, 4trustworthy.4 This is a description of Jibril as being trustworthy. This is something very great, that the Almighty Lord has commended His servant and angelic Messenger, Jibril, just as He has commended His servant and human Messenger, Muhammad jfe by His statement, 4And your companion is not a madman.} Ash-Sha’fi, Maymun bin Mihran, Abu Salih and others who have been previously mentioned, all said, “This refers to Muhammad jg.”^{*1} ‘Allah said, 4And indeed he saw him in the clear horizon .} meaning, indeed Muhammad sfe saw Jibril, who brought him the Message from Allah, in the form that Allah created him in (i.e., his true At-Tabari 24 :259, and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :434

form), and he had six hundred wings. 4in the clear horizon.\$ meaning, clear. This refers to the first sighting which occurred at Al-Batha’ (Makkah). This incident is mentioned in Allah’s statement, & sa0Uc p000% it Ti J) &-jb ris&f ji 4He /ias been taught by one mighty in power (Jibril). Dhu Mirrah,

then he rose. While he was in the highest part of the horizon. Then he approached and came closer. And was at a distance of two bows' length or less. So (Allah) revealed to His servant what He revealed.} (53:5-10)

The explanation of this and its confirmation has already

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6330]

preceded, as well as the evidence that proves that it is referring to Jibril. It seems apparent - and Allah knows best - that this Surah (At-Takwir) was revealed before the Night Journey (Al-Isra), because nothing has been mentioned in it except this sighting (of Jibril), and it is the first sighting. The second sighting has been mentioned in Allah's statement, *لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ يُصَوِّرُ مَا يَشَاءُ*. And indeed he saw him (Jibril) at a second descent. Near Sidrah Al-Muntaha. Near it is the Paradise of Abode. When that covered the lote tree which did cover it !} (53:13-16) And these Ayat have only been mentioned in Surat An-Najm,

which was revealed after Surat Al-Isra

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6330–6333]

(The Night Journey). The Prophet ﷺ is not Stingy in conveying the Revelation (He is not Zanin over the Unseen) version of Hafs ; “Some recite it . . .”

meaning Muhammad ﷺ is not following false conjecture about

what Allah revealed. Others have recited this Ayah with the ‘Dad’ in the word Danin, which means that he is not stingy, but rather he conveys it to everyone. Sufyan bin ‘Uyaynah said, “Zanin and Danin both have the same meaning. They mean that he is not a liar, nor is he a wicked, sinful person. The Zanin is one who follows false supposition, and the Danin is one who is stingy.”¹¹¹ Qatadah said, “The Qur’an was unseen and Allah revealed it to Muhammad ﷺ, and he did not withhold it from the people. Rather he announced it, conveyed it, and offered it to everyone who wanted it.” 'Ikrimah, Ibn Zayd and others have made similar statements. Ibn Jarir preferred the recitation Danin. [3] I say that both of recitations have been confirmed by numerous routes of transmission, and its meaning is correct either way, as we have mentioned earlier. The Qur’an is a Reminder for all the Worlds and It is not the Inspiration of Shaytan Allah says, *لَا يَأْتِيهِمْ سَاعَةٌ أَنْ يَأْتَخِطَ بَهَا قُلُوبُهُمْ لَوْ رَأَوْهُ إِلَّا تُنْفِیْهِمْ وَتُوْفًى بِهُمْ لِقَآءَهُمْ*. And it is not the word of the outcast Shaytan.} meaning, this Qur’an is not the statement of an outcast Shaytan. This means that he is not able to produce it, nor is it befitting of him to do so. This is as Allah says, *وَمَا يَنصُرُهُم فِيهِ إِلَّا اللَّهُ*. And it is not the Shaydn who have brought it down. Neither would it suit them nor they can. Verily, they have been removed far from hearing it.} (26:210-212) Then Allah says, *وَمَا يَنصُرُهُم فِيهِ إِلَّا اللَّهُ*. At-Tabari 24:261. ¹²¹ At-Tabari 24:261 At-Tabari 24 :260 , 261 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur⁸ :435

³⁸⁷Surah 81 . At-Takwir (15-29) (Part-30) Abu Jahl said, “The matter is up to us. If we wish, we will stand straight, and we do not wish, we will not stand straight.” So Allah revealed, *إِنَّا نَحْنُ غَنِيٌّ*. Cij Jii ibj J ujibj iAtid you cannot will unless (it be) that Allah wills - the Lord of the all that exists. ^

Surah 82: Al-Infitar

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6334]

Opening 388 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Tafsir of Surat Al-Infitar (Chapter - 82)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6334–6342]

The Virtues of Surat Al-Infitar An-Nasal recorded from Jabir that Mu'adh stood and lead the people in the Night prayer, and he made the recitation of his prayer long. So the Prophet jfc said, roif Qfr 3 iPX - iJ l; ait 5&t« “Are you putting the people to trial O Mu'adh? Why don't you recite iGlorify the Name of your Lord the Most High> (87), 4By the forenoon^ (93), and iWhen the heaven is cleft asunder (82)? ®”* 11 The basis of this Hadxth is found in the Two SahihsJ2 however the mentioning of 4When the heaven is cleft asunder.} has only been mentioned by An-Nasal. It has been previously mentioned in a narration from ‘Abdullah bin TJmar that the Prophet jg said, rail 4\$\$: \-jdi ^^ uoli Jj it^ ^1 “Whoever would be pleased to look at the Day of Resurrection with his own eyes, then let him recite, 4Wheti the sun is Kuwwirat.} (81) and; 4When the heaven is cleft asunder (82) and; 4When the heaven is split asunder} (84). ^ An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :508. 121 Fath Al-Bari 10 :532 , and Muslim 1 :339 Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :252

40 man! What has made you careless about your Lord, the Most Generous?} This is a threat. It is not an attempt to get a reply as some people mistakenly think. They consider it as if the Most Generous is asking them so that they will say, “His honor deceived him (or made him careless of his Lord).” rather the meaning of this Ayah is, “O Son of Adam! What has deceived you from your Lord, the Most Generous - meaning the Most Great - so that you went forth disobeying Him, and you met Him with that which was unbecoming.” This is similar to what has been reported in the Hadith, «Allah will say on the Day of Judgement: "O Son of Adam! What has deceived you concerning Me? O Son of Adam? What was your response to the Messengers Al-Baghawi mentioned that Al-Kalbi and Muqatil said, “This Ayah was revealed about Al-Aswad bin Shariq who struck the Prophet sis and he was not punished in retaliation. So Allah revealed, # c} 4What has made you careless about your Lord, the Most Generous?}”121 Then Allah said, 4Wfw created you, fashioned you perfectly, and gave you due proportion.} meaning, ‘what has deceived you concerning the Most Generous Lord?’ I 1 ' Tuhfat Al-Ashraf7 :70. This is the only reference for the Hadith, so its authenticity was unverifiable Al-Baghawi 4 :455 . This is a Mursal narration

4\$ iWho created you, fashioned you perfectly, and gave you due proportion.} meaning, ‘He made you complete, straight, and perfectly balanced and proportioned in stature. He fashioned you in the best of forms and shapes.’ Imam Ahmad recorded from Busr bin Jahhash Al-Qurashi that one day the Messenger of Allah jg spat in his palm and placed his finger on it. Then he said, 'H J~2 i>2 oij (ol b :J4-j y ill JIS» Ijl j iOJj vl£. i £4 'JZ olii il^JLp} jlji jx4 :oJLS cJjtj "Allah the Mighty and Sublime says : “O Son of Adam! How can you escape Me when I created you from something similar to this (spit)? Then I fashioned you and made your creation balanced so that you walked between the two outer garments. And the earth has a burial place for you. So you gathered (wealth) and withheld it until your soul reached your collarbone (i.e., death comes). Then, at that time you say, 7 will give charity now.’ But how will there be timefor charity?”^ This HadUh has also been recorded by Ibn Majah J21 Concerning Allah’s statement, iln whateverform He willed, He put you together.} Mujahid said, “In which resemblance: the father, the mother, the paternal uncle, or the maternal uncle.”131 In the Two Sahibs it is recorded from Abu Hurayrah that a man said, “O Messenger of Allah! Verily, my wife has given birth to a black boy.” The Prophet ig said, *?Jl! I* > Ahmad 4:210. 121 Ibn Majah 2:903. [31 At-Tabari 24:270.

393Surah 82. Al-Infidr (13-19) (Part-30 “Do you have any camels ?* The man said, “Yes.” The Prophet jfe then said, iWhat color are they?* The man said, “Red.”The Prophet jg said, “Do any o/ them have patches of gray?* The man said, “Yes.” The Prophet asked him, •Jiii lilii How did this happen to them?* The man replied, “It is probably an inherited genetical strain.”The Prophet jg then said, * i • t aLikewise, this (with your son) is probably an inherited genetical strain, d 1 11 The Cause of Deception and alerting to the Fact that Angels record the Deeds ofthe Children ofAdam Concerning Allah’s statement, & \$ iNay! But you deny (the Day of) Ad-Din .} meaning, “you are only compelled to oppose the Most Generous and meet Him with disobedience, by your rejection in your hearts of the Hereafter, the recompense and the reckoning.’ Concerning Allah’s statement. C tip 4But verily, over you to watch you (are) Kiraman Katibin, they know all that you do.} (82:10-12) meaning, ‘indeed there are noble guardian angels over you, so do not meet them with evil deeds, because they write down all that you do.’ in Fath Al-Bari 9:351, and Muslim 2:1137.

394 Tafslr Ibn Kathlir ojiJ lilLu "t (y U t• jr iSjidi fj> U titijji Uj iff 423. Verily, the Abrar (the righteous believers) will be in Delight;} 424. And verily, the wicked will be in the blazing Fire (Hell),} 415. Therein they will enter, and taste its burningflame on the Day ofRecompense,} 426. And they will not be absent therefrom.} 427. And what will make you know what the Day of Recompense is?} 418. Again, what will make you know what the Day of Recompense is?} 429. (It will be) the Day when no person shall have power for another, and the Decision, that Day, will be with AllSh.} The Reward ofthe Righteous and the Sinners Allah informs ofwhat the righteous will receive of delight. They are those who obeyed Allah and did not meet Him with disobedience (sins). Then He mentions that the evildoers will be in Hell and eternal torment. Due to this He says, fj.%&¥ 4Therein they will enter, and taste its burning flame on the Day ofRecompense,} meaning, the Day of Reckoning, Recompense, and Judgement. 4And they will not be absent therefrom.} meaning, they will not be absent for even one hour from the torment. The torment will not be lightened from them, nor will they be granted the death that they will be requesting, or any rest - not even for a single day. Allah then says, 4C|=ysi^ fk ^ *j} 4And what will make you know what the Day of Recompense is?}

395 Surah 82. Al-Infidhr (13-19) (Part-30 This is a magnification of the affair of the Day of Judgement. Then Allah affirms it by saying, 4 t* Xa y} 4 Again, what will make you know what the Day of Recompense is?) Then He explains this by saying, 4 (It will be) the Day when no person shall have power for another,} meaning, no one will be able to benefit anyone else, or help him out of that which he will be in, unless Allah gives permission to whomever He wishes and is pleased with. We will mention here a Haclith (where the Prophet jg said), flU—i 4)1 ^JLL.i V jllll I^JLaj t «0 children of Hdshim! Save yourselves from the Fire, for I have no power to cause you any benefit from Allah. This has been mentioned previously at the end of the Tafsir of Surat Ash-Shu‘ard (see 26:214). Thus, Allah says, ^%} i and the Decision, that Day, will be with Allah.} This is similar to Allah’s statement, iWhose is the kingdom this Day? It is Allah’s, the One, the Irresistible.} (40:16) It is also similar to His statement, 4The true sovereignty on that Day will be for the Most Gracious (25:26) It is also similar to His saying; 111 Muslim 1 :192.

iThe only Owner of the Day of Recompense.\$ (1:4) Qatadah said, i(It will be) the Day when no person shall have power for another, and the Decision, that Day, will be with AllSh “By Allah, the Decision is for Allah today (now), but on that Day no one will try to dispute with Him about it.”

Surah 83: Al-Mutaffifin

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Mutaffiftn

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6343–6349]

(Chapter - 83) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Vj) p* fk I*r^ "Jk ^ 41 . Woe to Al-Mutaffifin .} 42 . Those who, when they have to receive by measure from men, demand full measure, 43. And when they have to give by measure or weight to men, give less than due.} 44. Do they not think that they will be resurrected,} 45. On a Great Day?} 46. The Day when (all) mankind will stand before the Lord of all that exists?} Increasing and decreasing in the Measure and Weight will be a Cause for Regret and Loss An-Nasal and Ibn Majah both recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “When the Prophet came to Al-Madinah, the people of Al-Madinah were the most terrible people in giving measurement (i.e., they used to cheat). Thus, Allah revealed, 4Woe to Al-Mutaffifin .} After this, they began to give good measure.”¹¹¹ The meaning of the word Taffif here is to be stingy An-Nasat in Al-Kubra 6 :508 , and Ibn Majah 2 :748

398 Tafsir Ibn Kathir with measurement and weight, either by increasing it if it is due from the others, or decreasing it if it is a debt. Thus, Allah explains that the Mutaffifin - those whom He has promised loss and destruction, whom are meant by “Woe” - are ij*\$m 4 iThose who, when they have to receive by measure from men,} meaning, from among the people. 4demand full measure,} meaning, they take their right by demanding full measure and extra as well. 4And when they have to give by measure or weight to (other) men, give less than due.} meaning, they decrease. Verily, Allah commanded that the measure and weight should be given in full. He says in another Ayah, Sr\$ % -ft jXK %&} iAnd give full measure when you measure, and weigh with a balance that is straight. That is good and better in the end.} (17:35) Allah also says, A S if i,And give full measure and fill weight with justice. We burden not any person, but with that which he can bear.} (6:152) and He says, & \f4’j} 4And observe the weight with equity and do not make the balance deficient.} (55:9) Allah destroyed the people of Shu‘ayb and wiped them out because of their cheating in weights and measurements.

399 Surah 83. Al-Mutaffifin (1-6) (Part-30) Threatening the Mutaffifin with standing before the Lord of all that exists Then Allah says as a threat to them. 4Do they not think that they will be resurrected, on a Great Day?) meaning, do these people not fear the resurrection and standing before He Who knows the hidden matters and the innermost secrets, on a Day that contains great horror and tremendous fright? Whoever loses on this Day will be made to enter into a blazing fire. Then Allah says, 4The Day when (all) mankind will stand before the Lord of all that exists?) meaning, they will stand barefooted, naked and uncircumcised at a station that will be difficult, hard, and distressful for the criminals. They will be covered by the command from Allah, and it will be that, which the strength and the senses will not be able to bare. Imam Malik reported from Nafi* who reported from Ibn Umar that the Prophet jg said.

This will be the Day that mankind will stand before the Lord of all that exists, until one of them will sink up to the middle of his ears in sweat. Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith from Malik and ‘Abdullah bin ‘Awn, both of whom reported it from Nafi*.111 Muslim also recorded it from two routes . Another Hadith: Imam Ahmad recorded from Al-Miqdad, who was Ibn Al-Aswad Al-Kindi, that he heard the Messenger of Allah[^] saying, Path Al-Bari8 :565 Muslim 4:2195, 2196.

Jl j* p44 ^ ^~Lli\ - • ' • * • • • /! ' I, * ; * f- • ' * > - * -!> |, * ; * 1, • / i >' » y i*ijAp- J\ oJ^4 y fc 5rej y! d*^~^ y *Lal>Jl C*J>Ju •On the Day of Judgement, the sun will draw near the servants until it is a mile or two away from them. Then the sun will bum them, and they will be submersed in sweat based upon the amount of their deeds. From among them there will be those whose sweat will come up to their two heels. From among them there will be those whose sweat will come up to their two knees. From among them there will be those whose sweat will come up to their groins. From among them there will be those who will be bridled in sweat (up to their necks). This Hadith was recorded by Muslim and At-Tirmidhi. In Sunan Abu Dawud it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah used to seek refuge with Allah from the hardship of standing on the Day of Judgement. 121 It has been reported from Ibn Mas'Qd that they will be standing for forty years with their heads raised toward the sky. No one will speak to them, and the righteous and wicked among them will all be bridled in sweat. 131 It has been reported from Ibn TJmar that they will be standing for one hundred years. Both of these statements have been recorded by Ibn Jarir . In the Sunans of Abu Dawud, An-Nasal, and Ibn Majah, it is recorded from ‘A'ishah that the Messenger of Allah jg used to begin his late night prayer by declaring Allah's greatness ten times, praising Allah ten times, glorifying Allah ten times, and seeking Allah's forgiveness ten times. Then he would say, J^^ •O Allah! Forgive me, guide me, provide for me, and protect me. Then he would seek refuge from the hardship of the standing Ahmad 6 :3 , Muslim 2864 , and TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :89 121 Abu Dawud 1 :487 131 At-Tabari 24:281. At-Tabari 24:280.

on the Day of Judgement. 35&&&&& c *> uliC& -Js y>\ vjS Cj JXJJ?' ix.,»\$ J^Je (ny j* ?rl 1?^ ^ fCJ* £ S*> js ^ 4 oy'JS j* Ui JUj ^ (4^ f iAv 47. Nay! Truly, the Record of the wicked is in Sijjin.) 48. And what will make you know wlmt Sijjin is?} 49. A Register inscribed.) 410. Woe, that Day, to those who deny.} ill. Those who deny the Day ofRecompense.} 412. And none can deny it except every transgressor beyond bounds, the sinner!} 413. When Our Ayat are recited to him, lie says: "Tales of the ancients!"} 414. Nay! But on their hearts is the Ran (covering) which they used to earn.} il5. Nay! Surely, they will be veiled from seeing their Lord that Day.} 416. Then verily, they will indeed enter the burning flame of Hell.} 417. Then, it will be said to them: "This is what you used to deny!"} The Record oftheWicked andsome ofwhathappens to Them Allah says truly, jew- J* ^ iNay! Truly, the Record of the wicked is in Sijjin.} meaning, that their final destination and their abode will be in Sijjin, which is derived from the word prison (Sijn), and here it means straitened circumstances. Thus, Allah expresses the I 1 ' Abu Dawud 1 :486, An-Nasal 3 :299, and Ibn MSjah 1 :431

greatness of this matter, saying; l* &>} 4And what xoill make you know what Sijjin is?} meaning, it is a great matter, an eternal prison, and a painful torment. Some have said that it is beneath the seventh earth. It has been mentioned previously in the lengthy Hadith of Al- Bara' bin ‘Azib that the Prophet jg said, £jj tjt J*rj <u I JjZi aik,\U\ "Allah says concerning the soul of the disbeliever, ‘Record his book in Sijjin.' And Sijjin is beneath the seventh earthy it is known that the destination of the wicked people

will be Hell, and it is the lowest of the low. For Allah says, ﴿لَعَنَ اللَّهُ الْفَاسِقِينَ﴾ We reduced him to the lowest of the low. Save those who believe and do righteous deeds.} (95:5-6) Here Allah says, ﴿يُؤْتِيهِم مِّنْهُم مَّا يَشَاءُونَ﴾ Nay! Truly, the Record of the wicked is in Sijjin. And what will make you know what Sijjin is?} and it is full of hardship and misery. Allah says, ﴿وَلَمَّا نَسُواْ مَا وَعِدُواْ﴾ And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction.} (25:13) Then Allah says, ﴿أَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُمْ كِتَابٌ مِّنْ قَبْلُ﴾ This is not an explanation of His statement, At-Tiwal of Af-Tabar&ni 238, and similar with Al-Halrim 1 :37.

4And what will make you know what Sijjin is?> It is only an explanation of the destination that will be recorded for them, which is Sijjin. Meaning, it is inscribed, written, and completed. No one can add to it and no one can remove anything from it. This was said by Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi.' ' Then Allah said, 4Woe, that Day, to those who deny meaning, when they come to the imprisonment, Allah threatened them with, on the Day of Judgement, and the disgraceful torment. The statement, “Woe,” has already been discussed previously and there is no need to repeat it here. Basically, it means destruction and devastation. This is like

what is said, “Woe to so-and-so.” This is similar to what has

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6349–6358]

been recorded in the Musnad and the Sunan collections on the authority of Bahz bin Haldm bin Mu'awiyah bin Haydah, who reported from his father, who reported from his grandfather that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ﴿يُؤْتِيهِم مِّنْهُم مَّا يَشَاءُونَ﴾ (Jij •Woe unto whoever speaks, and lies in order to make the people laugh. Woe unto him, woe unto him .>|21 Then Allah says, in explaining who are the wicked, disbelieving deniers, iThose who deny the Day ofRecompense.> meaning, they do not believe it will happen, and they do not believe in its existence. Thus, they consider it a matter that is farfetched. Allah then says, iAnd none can deny it except every transgressor, sinner.> meaning, transgressive in his actions by doing that which is forbidden and exceeding the limits when acquiring the 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :444 ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd6 :509

permissible. He is a sinner in his statements, because he lies whenever he speaks, he breaks his promises whenever he makes them, and he behaves in an abusive and wicked manner whenever he argues. Concerning Allah's statement, iWhen Our Aydt are recited to him, he says: "Tales of the ancients!"} meaning, whenever he hears the Words of Allah from the Messenger he denies it and has ill thoughts about it. Thus, he believes that it is a collection gathered from the books of the ancients. This is as Allah says, ﴿يُؤْتِيهِم مِّنْهُم مَّا يَشَاءُونَ﴾ iAnd when it is said to them : "What is it that your Lord has sent down?" They say: "Tales of the men of old!"} (16:24) Similarly Allah says, iAnd they say: "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down: and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} (25:5) Then Allah continues saying, iNay! But on their hearts is the Ran (covering) which they used to earn.} meaning, the matter is not as they claim, nor as they say: “Verily, this Qur'an is tales of the ancients.” Rather, it is the Word of Allah, His inspiration and His revelation to His Messenger jg. The only thing that blocked their hearts from believing in it is the dark covering cast over it from the many sins and wrong they committed that has covered up their hearts. Thus, Allah says, iNay! But on

their hearts is the Ran (covering) which they used to earn.} This dark covering known as Rayn overcomes the hearts of the

405 Surah 83. Al-Mutaffifin (7-17) (Part-30) disbelievers, the covering of Ghaym is for the righteous, and the covering of Ghayn is for those who are near to Allah. Ibn Jarir, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nisal, and Ibn Majah all recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet said, *جاءني رجل من بني النضير فقال لي يا رسول الله اني اذ اذنب ذنبا ظن اني قد اخطيت به فاني اجد في قلبي كبريتا* -A-Jt oj® %<£ 15^&% A jbl iji il# SI3 i Verity, when the servant commits a sin, a black spot appears in his heart. If he repents from it, his heart is polished clean. However, if he increases (in the sin), the spot will continue to increase. That is the statement of Allah: *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*! But on their hearts is the Ran (covering) which they used to At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih.” The wording of An-Nasal says, *جاءني رجل من بني النضير فقال لي يا رسول الله اني اذنب ذنبا ظن اني قد اخطيت به فاني اجد في قلبي كبريتا* JU«3l jl 'ji} :JLu Jll Jli JJ1 Ll» ji*J tfj 1} SU- Jji k Ji-*' 'X ** rjy 1* 5b ji ^Whenever the servant commits a wrong, a black spot is put in his heart. So, if he refrains from it, seeks forgiveness and repents, his heart is polished clean. But if he returns to the sin, the spot will increase until it overcomes his (entire) heart, and this is the Ran that Allah mentions when He says : *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*, but on their hearts is the Ran (covering) which they used to earn.} Concerning Allah’s statement. *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*! Surely, they will be veiled from seeing their Lord that Day.} meaning, they will have a place on the Day of Judgement, and lodging in Sijjln. Along with this they will be veiled from seeing their Lord and Creator on the Day of Judgement. Imam Abu ‘Abdullah Ash-Shafil said, “In this Ayah is a proof that the believers will see Him (Allah), the Mighty and Sublime, on that Day.” 111 At-Tabari 24:287, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :253 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6:509, and Ibn Majah 2:1418.

407 Surah 83. Al-Mutaffifin (18-28) (Part-30) 423. On thrones , looking.} 424. You will recognize in their faces the brightness of delight 425. They will be given to drink of pure sealed Rahiq.} 426. Sealed with musk, and for this let those strive who want to strive. 427. It will be mixed with Tasntm :} 428. A spring whereof drink those nearest to Allah.} The Record Book of the Righteous and Their Reward Allah says that truly, *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة* Verily, the Record of Al-Abrar (the righteous believers)} These people are in a situation that is the opposite of the wicked people. *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة* is in 'Iliyyin .} meaning, their final destination is 'IUiyyin, which is the opposite of Sijjin. It has been reported from Hilal bin Yasaf that Ibn ‘Abbas asked Ka'b about Sijjin while he was present, and Ka*b said, “It is the seventh earth and in it are the souls of the disbelievers.” Then Ibn ‘Abbas asked him about 'IUiyyin, so he said, “It is the seventh heaven and it contains the souls of the believers.” 1 11 This statement - that it is the seventh heaven - has been said by others as well.*2 ‘All bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said concerning Allah’s state- ment, *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*! Verily, the Record of Al-Abrar (the righteous believers) is in 'IUiyyin.} “This means Paradise.”*3 ‘ Others besides him have said, **’ Al;-Tabari 24:291. ' At-Tabari 24:290. ' At-Tabari 24 : 292

408 Tafcir Ibtt Kathtr u,Iliyyln is located at Sidrat Al-Muntaha.”[n The obvious meaning is that the word 'IUiyyin is taken from the word Uluw, which means highness. The more something ascends and rises, the more it becomes greater and increases. Thus, Allah magnifies its affair and extols its matter by saying, *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*! And what will make you know what 'IUiyyin is?} Then He says by way of affirming what will be written for them. «&s®»a# £*> iA Register inscribed. To which bear witness those nearest.} They are the angels. This was stated by Qatadah.12 Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “Those nearest to Allah in each heaven will witness it.”^ Then Allah says, *انما على قلوبهم عتقاة*! Verily, Al-Abrar (the righteous

believers) will be in Delight.} meaning, on the Day of Judgement they will be in eternal pleasure and gardens that contain comprehensive bounties. iOn thrones,} These are thrones beneath canopies from which they will be gazing. It has been said, “This means that they will be gazing at their kingdom and what Allah has given them of good and bounties that will not end or perish. It has also been said, iOn thrones, looking.} “This means that they will be looking at Allah, the Mighty and Sublime.” This is the opposite of what those wicked people have been described with, if l 1 At-Tabari 24 :292 . Sidrat Al-Muntahd is the lote tree at the utmost boundary of the seventh heaven beyond which none can pass At-Tabari 24:294. At-Tabari 24:294.

4Na\j! Surely, they (evildoers) will be veiled from seeing their Lord that Day.) (83:15) Thus, it has been mentioned that these (righteous people) will be allowed to look at Allah while they Eire upon their thrones and elevated couches. Concerning Allah’s statement, 'l . \jJu j)You will recognize in their faces the brightness of delight. meaning, “you will notice a glow of delight in their faces when you look at them.’ This is a description of opulence, decorum, happiness, composure, and authority that they will be experiencing from this great delight. Concerning Allah’s statement, fry OJ iThey will be given to drink of pure sealed RahTq .) meaning, they will be given drink from the wine of Paradise. Ar-Rahiq is one of the names of the wine (in Paradise). Ibn Mas’fild, Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd all said this. Ibn Mas*Qd said concerning Allah’s statement, iSealed with musk,) “This means it will be mixed with musk.”121 Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “Allah will make the wine have a pleasant aroma for them, so the last thing that He will place in it will be musk. Thus, it will be sealed with musk.”131 Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak both said the same.141 Then Allah says, 4 Jjj'i j'j))and for this let (all) those strive who want to strive.) At-Tabari 24 :296 Al-Tabari 24 :297 At-Tabari 24:297. At-Tabari 24 :297, 298.

meaning, for a situation like this, let the boasters boast, compete, and strive to gain more. Let the competitors compete and race toward the likes of this. This is similar to Allah’s statement, 4L!> iFor the like of this let the workers work.} (37:61) Allah then says, 4i y ilt will be mixed with TastiTm .} meaning, this wine that is being described is mixed with Tasnim. This refers to a drink called Tasnim, and it is the most excellent and exalted drink of the people of Paradise. This was said by Abu Salih and Ad- Dahhak.' ' Thus, Allah says, 4A spring whereof drink those nearest to Allah.} (83:28) meaning, those who are near to Allah, will drink from it as they wish, and the companions of the right hand will be given a drink that is mixed with it. This has been said by Ibn Mas*uc;, Ibn ‘Abbas, Masruq, Qatadah and others.'21 IjjJ (>-r !ir* 5y»l» \)J tj gsJ OJ 5) qif St IX !*# *) Sj' fj?"" iX c 429. Verily, those who committed crimes used to laugh at those who believed.} 430. And, whenever they passed by them, used to wink one to another.} 431 . And when they returned to their own people, they would return jesting;} 432. And when they saw them, they said: "Verily, these have 111 At-Jabari 24:301. 121 At-Tabari 24:300, 301.

411 Surah 83. Al-Mutaffifin (29-36) (Part-30) indeed gone astray!”} 433. But they were not sent as watchers over them.} 434. But this Day those who believe will laugh at the disbelievers} 435. On thrones, looking.} 436. Are not the disbelievers paid for what they used to do?} The Wicked Behavior of the Criminals and Their mocking of the Believers Allah informs that the criminals used to laugh at the believers in the worldly life. In other words, they would mock them and despise them. Whenever they

would pass by the believers, they would wink at each other about them, meaning in contempt of them. 4And when they returned to their own people, they would return jesting.} meaning, when these criminals turn back, or return to their homes, they go back pleased. This means that whatever they request, they find it. Yet, with this, they still are not grateful for Allah's favor upon them. Rather they busy themselves with despising and envying the believers. J/j> ijli jijij \ij} 4And when they saw them, they said: "Verily, these have indeed gone astray!"} meaning, because they are upon a religion other than their own religion.' Allah then says, ijy %} 4But they were not sent as watchers over them.} meaning, these criminals have not been sent as guardians over the deeds and statements of these believers. These wrongdoers have not been made responsible for them. So, why are they so concerned with them, and why have they made them the focus of their attention? This is as Allah says,

^ «*£^&U*p>&S^'£&&% it\$u£X J> 4He (Allah) will say : "Remain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!" Verily there was a party of My servants, who used to say: "Our Lord! We believe, so forgive us, and have mercy on us, for You are the Best of all who show mercy!" But you took them for a laughing stock, so much so that they made you forget My remembrance while you used to laugh at them! Verily, I have rewarded them this Day for their patience: they are indeed the ones that are successful. (23 :108-111) Thus, Allah says here, <p& \$But this Day} meaning, the Day of Judgement. 4those who believe will laugh at the disbelievers meaning, as retribution for how those people laughed at them. \$} \$On thrones, looking.} meaning, looking at Allah as reward for bearing the false claims against them that they were misguided. They were not misguided at all. Rather they were the close AwUya of Allah, who will be looking at their Lord in the place of His honor. Concerning Allah's statement, C 'MX 4Are not the disbelievers paid for what they used to do?} meaning, "will the disbelievers be recompensed for their mockery and belittlement against the believers, or not?" This means that they surely will be paid in full, completely and perfectly (for their behavior). This is the .end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Mutaffifin, and all praise and thanks are due to Allah.

Surah 84: Al-Inshiqaq

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6359–6368

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6359]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Inshiqaq (Chapter - 84)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6359–6361]

The Prostration of Recitation in Surat Al-Inshiqaq It is reported from Abu Salamah that while leading them in prayer, Abu Hurayrah recited, {When the heaven is split asunder.} and he prostrated during its recitation. Then when he completed the prayer, he informed them that the Messenger of Allah prostrated during its recitation. This was recorded by Muslim and An-Nasab on the authority of Malik. 1 ' Al-Bukhari recorded from Abu Rafi' that he prayed the Night prayer with Abu Hurayrah, and he (Abu Hurayrah) recited, {When the heaven is split asunder.} then he prostrated. So Abu Rafi' said something to him about it (questioning it). Abu Hurayrah replied, "I prostrated behind Abul-Qasim (the Prophet M), and I will never cease prostrating during its recitation until I meet him." 2' In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 3) £ tt tz% dj yt4 CH & Hi df) Z @44 %£ k ^ d 3fA @54& 4P @44£ 7\$ 111 Muslim 1 :406, and An-Nasab in Al-Kubra 6 :510. ' Path Al-Bari 1 :292

•jpf*! -ft %) J 41 . When the heaven is split asunder,} 42. And listens to and obeys its Lord - and it must do so.} 43. And when the earth is stretched forth,^ 44. And has cast out all that was in it and became empty.> 45. And listens to and obeys its Lord - and it must do so.} 46. O man! Verily, you are returning towards your Lord with your deeds and actions, a sure returning, and you will meet.} 47. Then as for him who will be given his Record in his right hand,} 48. He surely will receive an easy reckoning,} 49. And will return to his family Masrur (in joy)!} 410. But whosoever is given his Record behind his back,} 411. He will invoke destruction,} 412. And he shall enter a blazing Fire, and made to taste its burning.} 423. Verily, he was among his people in joy!} 414. Verily, he thought that he would never return!} 415. Yes! Verily, his Lord has been ever beholding him!} Splitting the Heavens asunder and stretching the Earth forth on the Day of Resurrection Allah says, {When the heaven is split asunder,} This refers to the Day of Judgement. ity.m {And listens to and obeys its Lord} meaning, it listens to its Lord and obeys His command to split apart. This will occur on the Day of Judgement. 4<? nd it must do so.} meaning, it is right for it to obey the command of its Lord, because it is great and cannot be rejected,

415 Surah 84. Al-Inshiqaq (1-15) (Part-30) nor overcome. Rather it overpowers everything and everything is submissive to it. Then Allah says, {And when the earth is stretched forth,

meaning, when the earth is expanded, spread out and extended. Then He says, % ft c 4And has cast out all that was in it and became empty.} meaning, it throws out the dead inside of it, and it empties itself of them. This was said by Mujahid, Said, and Qatadah. 4And listens to and obeys its Lord, and it must do so.}

The explanation of this is the same as what has preceded.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6361–6368]

The Recompense for Deeds is True Allah says, <0 man! Verily, you are returning towards your Lord with your deeds and actions, a sure rehtming,} meaning, Verily you are hastening to your Lord and working deeds.’ iand you will meet.} Then you will meet that which you did of good or evil.’ A proof for this is what Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded from Jabir, that the Messenger ofAllah said, [y>] 4 c-L? U Jj? tJuAi U JI *Jibril said, "O Muhammad! Live how you wish, for verily you will die; love what you wish, for verily you will part with it; and do what you wish, for verily you will meet it (your deed).’>121 111 At-Tabari 24:310. ^ Musnad At-Tayalisino . 242

There are some people who refer the pronoun back to the statement “your Lord.” Thus, they hold the Ayah to mean, “and you will meet your Lord.” This means that He will reward you for your work, and pay you for your efforts. Therefore, both of these two views are connected. Al-‘Awfi recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said explaining, 40 matt! Verily, you are returning towards your Lord with your deeds and actions, a sure returning,} “Whatever deed you do, you will meet Allah with it, whether it is good or bad.” ThePresentationandtheDiscussionthatwilltakeplace during the Reckoning Then Allah says, 4 Sfei »• ijj-i , y '.L..4; \C& >3j' Cr \$Then as for him who will be given his Record in his right hand, he surely, will receive an easy reckoning,} (84:7-8) meaning, easy without any difficulty. This means that he will not be investigated for all the minute details of his deeds. For verily, whoever is reckoned like that, he will certainly be destroyed. Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘A’ishah that the Messenger of Allah said, ' 1—>»J l aWhoever is interrogated during the reckoning, then he will be punished . ‘A’ishah then said, “But didn’t Allah say, 4He surely will receive an easy reckoning,}?” The Prophet jg replied, y ^ja t I \llii illi Jb At-Jabari 24 :312

417Surah 84. Al-Inshiqaq (1-15) (Part-30) “That is not during to the Reckoning, rather it is referring to the presentation. Whoever is interrogated during the Reckoning on the Dai/ ofJudgement, then he will be punished This Hadith has also been recorded by Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn JarirJ2 ' In reference to Allah’s statement, 4 .4*1 i£^j} iAnd will return to his family Masriir!} This means that he will return to his family in Paradise. This was said by Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak. They also said, “Masriir means happy and delighted by what Allah has given him.”[3 ' Allah said; ,v.oik ;lu li} j4 ftf} iBut zohosoever is given his Record behind his back,} meaning, he will be given his Book in his left hand, behind his back, while his hand is bent behind him. iHe will invoke destruction,} meaning, loss and destruction. 4And he shall enter a blazing Fire, and made to taste its burning. Verily, he was among his people in joy!} meaning, happy. He did not think about the consequences, nor feared what (future) was in front of him. His light happiness will be followed by long grief. iVerily, he thought that he would never return!} meaning, he used to believe that he would not return to Allah, nor would Allah bring him back (to life) after his death. This was said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Qatadah and others.141 Allah then

says, ^ Ahmad 6 :47 Fath Al-Bari 8 :566, Muslim 4 :2204, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :256, An- Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:510, and At-Tabari 24 :315. At-Tabari 24:315. At-Tabari 24:317.

419Surali 84. Al-Inshiqd (16-25) (Part-30 425. Save those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them is a reward that will never come to an end.} Swearingby the Various Stages ofMan'sJourney It has been reported from 'Ali, Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ubadah bin As- Samit, Abu Hurayrah, Shaddad bin Aws, Ibn 'Umar, Muhammad bin 'Ali bin Al-Husayn, Makhul, Bakr bin 'Abdullah Al-Muzani, Bukayr bin Al-Ashaj, Malik, Ibn Abi Dhib, and 'Abdul-'Aziz bin Abi Salamah Al-Majishun, they all said, "Ash-Shafaq is the redness (in the sky)." 'Abdur-Razzaq recorded from Abu Hurayrah that he said, "Ash-Shafaq is the whiteness. So Ash-Shafaq is the redness of the horizon, either before sunset, as Mujahid*31 said or after sunset, as is well known with the scholars of the Arabic Language. Al-Khalil bin Ahmad said, "Ash-Shafaq is the redness that appears from the setting of sun until the time of the last Isha (when it is completely dark). When that redness goes away, it is said, 'Ash-Shafaq has disappeared.' "4 Al-Jawhari said, "Ash-Shafaq is the remaining light of the sun and its redness at the beginning of the night until it is close to actual nighttime (darkness)." Ikrimah made a similar statement when he said, "Ash-Shafaq is that what is between Al-Maghrib and Al-'IshaV' In the Sahih of Muslim, it is recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr that the Messenger of Allah jg said, >~«u u i Ji cjj The time of Al-Maghrib is as long as Ash-Shafaq has not disappeared .»"51 In all of this, there is a proof that Ash-Shafaq is as Al-Jawhari and Al-Khalil have said. Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Qatadah, all said that, m Al-Qurtubi 19:274. 121 'Abdur-Razzaq 3:358. At-Tabari 24:318. [4] Al-Qurtubi 19:275. Muslim 1 :426

and what it Wasaqa} means "What it gathers."111 Qatadah said, "The stars and animals it gathers."121 Ikrimah said, \$And by the night and what it Wasaqa,} "What it drives into due to its darkness, because when it is nighttime everything goes to its home."131 Concerning Allah's statement, iAtid by the moon when it Ittasqa .} Ibn 'Abbas said, "When it comes together and becomes complete."141 Al-Hasan said, "When it comes together and becomes full."151 Qatadah said, "When it completes its cycle."161 These statements refer to its light when it is completed and becomes full, as the idea was initiated with "The night and what it gathers." Allah said, iYou shall certainly travelfrom stage to stage.} Al-Bukhari recorded from Mujahid that Ibn 'Abbas said, iYou shall certainly travelfrom stage to stage.} "Stage after stage. Your Prophet gg has said this." Al-Bukhari recorded this statement with this wording. 'Ikrimah said, <> 111 At-Tabari 24:319. 121 At-Tabari 24:320. 131 At-Tabari 24:321. 141 At-Tabari 24:321. 151 At-Tabari 24:321. 161 At-Tabari 24:322. 171 Fath Al-Bari8 :567

421Surah 84. Al-Inshiqaq (16-25) (Part-30 iFrom stage to stage.\$ "Stage after stage. 111 Weaned after he was breast feeding, and an old man after he was a young man." Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, iFrom stage to stage.} "Stage after stage.121 Ease after difficulty, difficulty after ease, wealth after poverty, poverty after wealth, health after sickness, and sickness after health." The Disapproval of Their Lack of Faith, giving Them Tidings ofthe Torment, and that the Ultimate Pleasure will be for the Believers Allah said, iWhat is the matter with them, that they believe not? And when the Qur'an is recited to them, they fall not prostrate.} meaning, what prevents them from believing in Allah, His Messenger^ and the Last Day, and what is wrong with them that when Allah's Ayat and His Words are recited to them they do not prostrate due to awe, respect and reverence? Concerning Allah's statement, it iNay, those who

disbelieve deny.} meaning, from their mannerism is rejection, obstinacy, and opposition to the truth. ±P %> iAnd Allah knows best what they gather,} Mujahid and Qatadah both said, “What they conceal in their chests.”¹³¹ 4So, announce to them a painful torment.} meaning, ‘inform them, O Muhammad, that Allah has prepared for them a painful torment.’ Then Allah says, At-Tabari 24:323. At-Tabari 24:323. At-Tabari 24:327.

4Saye those who believe and do righteous good deeds, This is a clear exception meaning, “but those who believe.’ This refers to those who believe in their hearts. Then the statement, “and do righteous good deeds,” is referring to that which they do with their limbs. 4for them is a reward^ meaning, in the abode ofthe Hereafter. ithat will never come to an end.} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Without being decreased.” ’ Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak both said, “Without measure.”² ’ The result of their statements is that it (the reward) is without end. This is as Allah says, iA gift without an end.} (11:108) As-Suddi said, “Some of them have said that this means without end and without decrease.”

Surah 85: Al-Buruj

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Buruj

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6369–6370]

(Chapter - 85) In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. (35s®) v' <3? jW'-j *-rr *-!?!?--^ »rr .-: T! V'i ^ ^ 1^7 j>*» > 4 t£t\$+& >\ ' '>s~ ^ / %2yj *yr* Oj»i V» (jp \$t !Ai3d ^ ^ ^ri '.£* £> i£ rfjft iff vS^ C£rf3\$ iji c/il Cp -1 rri £& ;# !i>; ji ? *\$£ 4? • By the heaven holding the Burujf And by the Promised Dayf 43. And by the Witness and by the Witnessedf 44. Cursed were the People of the Ditchf 45. Offired withJuelf 46. When they sat by itf 47. And they witnessed what they were doing against the

believers.} i8. And they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy of all praise!} 49. To Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth! And Allah is Witness over everything.} 410. Verily, those who put into trial the believing men and believing women, and then do not turn in repentance, then they will have the torment of Hell, and they will have the punishment of the burning Fire.} The Interpretation of the Word Buruj Allah swears by the heaven and its Buruj. The Buruj are the giant stars, as Allah says, iBlessed is He Who has placed in the heaven Buruj, and has placed therein a great lamp (the sun), and a moon giving light.} (25:61) Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As- Suddi, all said, “Al-Buruj are the stars.”111 Al-Minhal bin ‘Amr said, }By the heaven holding the Buruj.} “The beautiful creation.”*2 Ibn Jarir chose the view that it means the positions of the sun and the moon, which are twelve Buruj. The sun travels through each one of these “Buij” (singular of Buruj) in one month. The moon travels through each one of these Burj in two-and-a-third days, which makes a total of twenty-eight positions, and it is hidden for two nights.*3

The Explanation of the Promised Day and the Witness

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6370–6371]

and the Witnessed Allah says, Al-Qurtubi 19:200. 121 Al-Qurtubi 19:283. At-Tabari 24 :332

4A;i4 by the Promised Day. And by the Witness, and by the Witnessed. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jfa; said. Sii jbj jLts-S xp 144*13! v <pts< <-ij iSiiAii j»3i jJ»*i £ It i** v; iSiSj JUa/f ni i^- 4Ah4 by the Promised Day.} This refers to the Day of judgement. iAnd by the Witness.£ This refers to Friday, and the sun does not rise or set on a day that is better than Friday. During it there is an hour that no Muslim servant catches while asking AllShfrom some good except that Allah will give it to him . He does not seek refuge from any evil in it except that Allah will protect him. iAnd by the Witnessed.} This refers to

the day of 'Arafah (in Hajj)).»**•

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6371–6382]

Ibn Khuzaymah also recorded the same Hadith. It has also been recorded as a statement of Abu Hurayrah and it is similar (to this Hadith) It has been reported from Abu Hurayrah, Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan bin 'Ali, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Mujahid, Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak that they all said that here the Witnessed refers to the Day of Judgement. Al-Baghawi said, "The majority considers the Witness to be Friday, and the Witnessed to be the day of Arafah .",3) The Oppression of the People of the Ditch against the Muslims Concerning Allah's statement, && iCursed were (Qutila) the People of the Ditch (Ukhdiid).} At-Tabari 24:332. I2 * Ibn Khuzaymah 3:116. I3 ' Al-Baghawi 4 : 466

{And Allah is Witness over everything meaning, nothing is concealed from Him in all of the heavens and the earth, nor is anything hidden from Him. The Story of the Sorcerer, the Monk, the Boy and Those Who were forced to enter the Ditch Imam Ahmad recorded from Suhayb that the Messenger of Allah said, ji JI rjldj Jli ^LDI 'jS llii iJ JiSj illi J±i Jtf jLi li-iu. Ji ££ Ji J- 'Js Jj. f^Jji jti 4~?0 410 o?.j 55 jisj iik; 1* ijlij y^"l*Jl bj jISj 4iA^Sj :jUi ^\^l JI Jjji l£ii U : Jli} iUl jf dp ?iJL^~ ji ^di^t iijt 4^1*1 1 ^* J _^>-i^Ji lij ji i4bi ;ud dis Ji J{ ii f>; od^ uiri :jd 4>-iui :Jii Jj 4-^' v_^pJi 'A r^' fp 's\MM *i ,>dJi c.,;ii 4-i-t 4-^Jl ^it jis 5l :jui itG : Jli jt ft ill 4i£a uu3j '5"'^' 24* jt 5* dull oAmong the people who came before you, there was a king who had a sorcerer, and when that sorcerer became old, he said to the king, "/ have become old and my time is nearly over, so please send me a boy whom I can teach magic." So, he sent him a boy and the sorcerer taught him magic. Whenever the boy went to the sorcerer, he sat with a monk who was on the way and listened to his speech and admired them . So, when he went to the sorcerer, he passed by the monk and sat there with him; and on visiting the sorcerer the latter would thrash him. So, the boy complained about this to the monk. The monk said to him, "Whenever you are afraid of the sorcerer, say to him: 'My people kept me busy.' And whenever you are afraid of your people, say to them: 'The sorcerer kept me busy.' " So the boy

428 TafsTr Ibn KathTr carried on like that (for some time). Then a huge terrible creature appeared on the road and the people were unable to pass by. The boy said, "Today I shall know whether the sorcerer is better or the monk is better." So, he took a stone and said, "O Allah! If the deeds and actions of the monk are liked by You better than those of the sorcerer, then kill this creature so that the people can cross (the road)." Then he struck it with a stone killing it and the people passed by on the road. j^i vliJ^j J-iif vj iJj : Jlii vIUJo jS-'j J'sSb JISli ^ ^ u iu.3 t :Jia Vj\$ UOjj tti ^ [jjpr 4UIU b\^Sj £j'fe-s <> jji y iil Ulj ui li : Jlii .olili iul Uii jili liillii ill The boy came to the monk and informed him about it. The monk said to him, "O my son! Today you are better than I, and you have achieved what I see! You will be put to trial. And in case you are put to trial, do not inform (them) about me." The boy used to treat the people suffering from congenital blindness, leprosy, and other diseases. There was a courtier of the king who had become blind and he heard about the boy. He came and brought a number of gifts for the boy and said, "All these gifts are for you on the condition that you cure me." The boy said, "I do not cure anybody; it is only Allah who cures people. So, if you believe in Allah and supplicate to Him, He will cure you." So, he believed in and supplicated to Allah, and Allah cured him. Ij j. ib-ti u :iio 3 Jlii jjjj, jii i; 3^ jJU iudi j\ p Vj : JI* bijjj vV : Jli : Jlii . - Jlii ?iJ>: villi fJl vi-*J J* JS AjSm Jji pa (4)1 tljjj : Jli

U : Jli U^lVI 'SXj »;Vl3 itfVl j,g£[^] : Jlii 4o ilijf : Jli i :Jli ?IM : Jli jh u!| l[^]{ Jb\ J* ji[^] Aj Jjj |»ii Vjjliillj
Laj! ojb[^]li (111 illbjj [^]j '. Jli Jy* J> jlilJi l v#![^] btLii jZ gr'J : Jlii v-[^]l[^]Jl; jfo v__[^]i[^]Jl

429Surah 85. Al-Buruj (1-10) (Part-30 If jrj' vH*j i>Ui j~.fj <•1\$* l,4ti o* £rj' £>} t/*" frO <3[^] VI}
&*f C?J4 «&* r[^] 'H :[^]J M iC[^] L*j j, j/.a*) |V[^]Jl ! JIS [^]JlAjl a> I}1* L*A» i o[^]A_Ui_ij : JUi 4* &->
<*£*" ilr~[^]*i fV[^] *lsr-j l[^]AJiAJi Jl»Jl |*-f» lil : Jlii [^] aj i[^]JUu 5il f-t~iOs :JL5» ?iii>Uw>l J*i la jui }
A3i * 1 ,_** °_>*S** [^]b iikif g?j4 it . <1) I[^]j5jA* (drf l»J [^] gl'5[^] I fl U l [^]VaJl Later, the courtier came
to the king and sat at the place where he used to sit before. The king said, "Who gave you back your
sight?" The courtier replied, "My Lord." The king then said, "I did?" The courtier said, "No, my Lord
and your Lord - Allah." The king said, "Do you have another Lord beside me?" The courtier said, "Yes,
your Lord and my Lord is Allah." The king tortured him and did not stop until he told him about the
boy. So, the boy was brought to the king and he said to him, "O boy! Has your magic reached to the
extent that you cure congenital blindness, leprosy and other diseases?" He said, "I do not cure anyone.
Only Allah can cure." The king said, "Me?"111 The boy replied, "No." The king asked, "Do you have
another Lord besides me?" The boy answered, "My Lord and your Lord is Allah." So, he tortured him
also until he told about the monk. Then the monk was brought to him and the king said to him,
"Abandon your religion." The monk refused and so the king ordered a saw to be brought which was
placed in the middle ofhis head and he fell, sawn in two. Then it was said to the man who used to be
blind, "Abandon your religion." He refused to do so, and so a saw was brought and placed in the middle
of his head and he fell, sawn in two. Then the boy was brought and it was said to him, "Abandon your
religion." He refused and so the king sent him to the top of such and such mountain with some people.
He told the people, "Ascend up the mountain with him till you reach its peak, then I1 ' This statement
ofthe king is only in the version with Ahmad

see if he abandons his religion ; otherwise throw him from the top." They took him and when they
ascended to the top, he said, "O Allah! Save me from them by any means that You wish." So, the
mountain shook and they all fell down and the boy came back walking to the king. The king said,
"What did your companions (the people I sent with you) do?" The boy said, "Allah saved me from
them." So, the king ordered some people to take the boy on a boat to the middle of the sea, saying, "Ifhe
renounces his religion (well and good), but if he refuses, drown him." So, they took him out to sea and
he said, "O Allah! Save me from tltem by any means that you wish." So they were all drowned in the
sea. [^]U ! Jlli tliLaJl U Ojf » j, h'Jii U jjjc Jjli cjj ei\ ;jdJj Jii p Ju: r~"H •() * r 1 Jt Q-- p j>.lj [^]y! (4[^] £fJJ
viii li| iuji 4<J >Jj ijpJ-o jji |» jjjI : JU_ j olj U c-jtjl J-ij . (iil :[^]«0 I Jlii ioUj [^]4—it iJLSLJl ;l[^]iL [^]01 JJ
til 3y «5llj Jii ?jJ>J 'fo <Ai If (fr) y -dti'j fb\Jl\ I4J iiU-Vt l[^]-i »Ij3l oJlAi KjjjoijSj IjJisi : Jl» t l\$ j ojpoti
jjle- .>01 jj! jf C-.-ilil IpUj Then the boy returned to the king and the king said, "What did your
companions do?" The boy replied, "Allah, saved me from than." Then he said to the king, "You will not
be able to kill me until you do as I order you. And ifyou do as I order you, you will be able to kill me."
The king asked, "And what is that?" The boy said, "Gather the people in one elevated place and tie me
to the trunk of a tree ; then take an arrow from my quiver and say: "In the Name ofAllah, the Lord of
the boy.' If you do this, you will be able to kill me." So he did this, and

431Surah 85. Al-Buruj (1-10) (Part-30 placing an arrow in the bow, he shot it, saying, "In the Name of
Allah, the Lord of the boy." The arrow hit the boy in the temple, and the boy placed his hand over the

arrow wound and died. The people proclaimed, "We believe in the Lord of the boy!" Then it was said to the king, "Do you see what has happened? That which you feared has taken place. By Allah, all the people have believed (in the Lord of the boy)." So he ordered that ditches be dug at the entrances to the roads and it was done, and fires were kindled in them. Then the king said, "Whoever abandons his religion, let him go, and whoever does not, throw him into the fire." They were struggling and scuffling in the fire, until a woman and her baby whom she was breast feeding came and it was as if she was being somewhat hesitant offalling into the fire, so her baby said to her, "Be patient mother! For verily, you are following the truth!" Muslim also recorded this Hadith at the end of the SahihP^ Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar related this story in his book of Sirah in another way that has some differences from that which has just been related. Then, after Ibn Ishaq explained that the people of Najran began following the religion of the boy after his murder, which was the religion of Christianity, he said, "Then (the king) DhU Nuwas came to them with his army and called them to Judaism. He gave them a choice to either accept Judaism or be killed, so they chose death. Thus, he had a ditch dug and burned (some of them) in the fire (in the ditch), while others he killed with the sword. He made an example of them (by slaughtering them) until he had killed almost twenty thousand of them. It was about Dhu Nuwas and his army that Allah revealed to His Messenger 3A c & # > Si lui % 4\ & U. iS % fc ^Cursed were the People of the Ditch. Offire fed with fuel. I 1 ' Ahmad 6:16. Muslim 4 :2299 . It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi in the Book of Tafsir.

When they sat by it. And they witnessed what they were doing against the believers. And they had no fault except that they believed in Allah, the Almighty, Worthy of all praise! To Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth! And Allah is Witness over everything (85 :4-9)" This is what Muhammad bin Ishaq said in his book of Sirah - that the one who killed the People of the Ditch was Dhu Nuwas, and his name was Zur'ah. In the time of his kingdom he was called Yusuf. He was the son of Tuban As'ad Abi Karib, who was the Tubba' who invaded Al-Madlnah and put the covering over the Ka'bah. [1 ^ He kept two rabbis with him from the Jews of Al-Madinah. After this some of the people of Yemen accepted Judaism at the hands of these two rabbis, as Ibn Ishaq mentions at length. So Dhu Nuwas killed twenty thousand people in one morning in the Ditch. Only one man among them escaped. He was known as Daws Dhu Thalaban. He escaped on a horse and they set out after him, but they were unable to catch him. He went to Caesar, the emperor of Ash-Sham. So, Caesar wrote to An-Najashi, the King of Abyssinia. So, he sent with him an army of Abyssinian Christians, who were lead by Aryat and Abrahah. They rescued Yemen from the hands of the Jews. Dhu Nuwas tried to flee but eventually fell into the sea and drowned. After this, the kingdom of Abyssinia remained under Christian power for seventy years. Then the power was divested from the Christians by Sayf bin Dhi Yazin Al-Himyari when Kisra, the king of Persia sent an army there (to Yemen). He (the king) sent with him (Sayf Al-Himyari) those people who were in the prisons, and they were close to seven hundred in number. So, he (Sayf Al-Himyari) conquered Yemen with them and returned the kingdom back to the people of Himyar (Yemenis). We will mention a portion of this - if Allah wills - when we discuss the Tafsir of die Surah: iHave you not seen how your Lord dealt with the Owners of the Elephant?^ (105:1) I 1 ' Ibn Hisham 1 : 36. *21 See volume nine, the Tafsir of SuratAd-Dukh&n (44 :37)

433Surah 85. Al-Burij (11-22) (Part-30) The Punishment ofthe People ofthe Ditch Allah said, 4Verily, those who put into trial the believing men and believing women,} meaning, they burned (them). This

was said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, and Ibn Abza. and then do not turn in repentance,} meaning, “they do not cease from what they are doing, and do not regret what they had done before.” 4 4>& ’fit) ’ftr v’-i j^fi} 4then they will have the torment of Hell, and they will have the punishment of the burning Fire.} This is because the recompense is based upon the type of deed performed. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, “Look at this generosity and kindness. These people killed Allah’s Awliya’ and He still invites them to make repentance and seek forgiveness.” k £31# \pc& l[] 32 ^145 ;> >%^3 & it «»!> 4 ’i>£)> && j* Q g? 4 rn’-« 411 . Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them will be Gardens under which rivers flow. That is the supreme success.} 412. Verily, the punishment of your Lord is severe and painful.} 413. Verily, He it is Who begins and repeats.} 414. And He is Oft-Forgiving, Al-Wadud.} 415. Owner of the Throne, Al-Majid (the Glorious).} m At-Tabari 24 :343 , 344

435Surah 85. Al-Buriii (11-22) (Part-30) no matter what the sin may be. Ibn ‘Abbas and others have said about the name Al-Wadud, “It means Al-Hablb (the Loving).”111 iOivtier of the Throne,} meaning, the Owner of the Mighty Throne that is above all of the creation. Then He says, 4Al-Majtd (the Glorious).} This word has been recited in two different ways: either with a Dhammah over its last letter (Al- Majidu), which is an attribute of the Lord, or with a Kasrah under its last letter (Al-Majid), which is a description of the Throne. Nevertheless, both meanings are correct. 4Doer ofwlmt He intends.} meaning, whatever He wants He does it, and there is no one who can counter His ruling. He is not asked about what He does due to His greatness, His power, His wisdom and His justice. This is as we have related previously from Abu Bakr As-Siddlq, that it was said to him during the illness of (his) death, “Has a doctor seen you?” He replied, “Yes.” They said, “What did he say to you?” He replied, “He said, 1 am the Doer ofwhatever I intend.”121 Concerning Allah’s statement, iHas the story reached you of the hosts. Of Fir’awn and Thamiid?} meaning, has the news reached you of what Allah caused to befall them of torment, and that He sent down upon them the punishment that no one was able to ward off from them? This is the affirmation of His statement, 4 Verily, the punishment ofyour Lord is severe and painful.} meaning, when He seizes the wrongdoer, He seizes him with a At-Tabari 24:346. 121 Al-Qurtubi 19:297.

severe and painful punishment. It is the seizing punishment of One Most Mighty, and Most Powerful. Then Allah says, 4Nay! The disbelievers (persisted) in denying.} meaning, they are in doubt, suspicion, disbeliefand rebellion. m’•« & 4And Allah encompasses themfrom behind!} meaning, He has power over them, and is able to compel them. They cannot escape Him or evade Him. 4Nay! This is a Glorious Qur’an.} meaning, magnificent and noble. \$ 3} 41n Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz!} meaning, among the most high gathering, guarded from any increase, decrease, distortion, or change.

Surah 86: At-Tariq

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6383–6389]

Opening 49. The Day when all the secrets will be examined.} 410. Then he will have no power, nor any helper.} Swearing by the Existence of Humanity surrounded by the Organized System of Allah Allah swears by the heaven and what He has placed in it of radiant stars. Thus, He says, 4By the heaven, and At-Tdriq;} Then He says, 4And what will make you to know what At-Tariq is?} Then He explains it by His saying, 4The star of Ath-Thaqib.} Qatadah and others have said, “The star has been named Tariq because it is only seen at night and it is hidden during the day.” * His view is supported by what has been mentioned in the authentic Hadith that prohibits a man to come to his family Taruq. This means that he comes to them unexpectedly at nighttimeJ2 Concerning Allah’s statement, i£&} 4Ath-Thdqib.} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The illuminating. ”,31 ‘Ikrimah said, “It is illuminating and it bums the Shaytan.” Then Allah says. 4There is no human being but has a protector over him.} meaning, every soul has a guardian over it from Allah that protects it from the calamities. This is as Allah says, 4\$ Cii -jit- £g. It » At-Tabari 24:351. 121 FathAl-Bari9:251 At-Tabari 24:352.

439Surah 86. At-Tariq (1-10) (Part-30) }For Him, there are angels in succession, before and behind him. They guard him by the command of Allah.} (13:1 1) HowMan iscreated isa ProofofAllah’s AbilitytoReturn Him toHim Allah says. iSo, let man seefrom what he is created!} This is alerting man to the weakness of his origin from which he was created. The intent of it is to guide man to accept (the reality of) the Hereafter, because whoever is able to begin the creation then he is also able to repeat it in the same way. This is as Allah says, i * >> > 2 jjEJT 4 \ Ji> 4And He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easierfor Him.} (30:27) Then Allah says, 4He is created from a water gushing forth.} meaning, the sexual fluid that comes out bursting forth from the man and the woman. Thus, the child is produced from both of them by the permission of Allah. Due to this Allah says, ^Proceedingfrom between the backbone and the ribs.} meaning, the backbone (or loins) of the man and the ribs of the woman, which is referring to her chest. Shabib bin Bishr reported from Ikrimahwho narrated from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said. ^Proceedingfrom between the backbone and the ribs.} “The backbone of the man and the ribs of the woman. It (the fluid) is yellow and fine in texture. The child will not be bom except from both of them (i.e., their sexual fluids).” 111 Ad-DurrAl-ManthOr 8 :475 .

Concerning Allah’s statement, -*“-j ii- £[] iVerily, He is Able to bring him back (to life)!} This means that He is able to return this man that is created from fluid gushed forth. In other words, He is able to repeat his creation and resurrect him to the final abode. This is clearly possible, because whoever is able to begin the creation then he surely is able to repeat it. Indeed Allah has mentioned this proof in more than one place in the Qur’an. On the Day ofJudgement, Man will have no Power or Assistance In this

regard Allah says, #0 iThe Day when all the secrets will be examined.} meaning, on the Day of Judgement the secrets will be tested. This means that they will be exposed and made manifest. Thus, the secret will be made open and that which is concealed will be well known. It is confirmed in the Two Sahls on the authority of Ibn Umar that the Messenger of Allah ig said, SjJLP oJlA liJLL 1 XjP «Every betrayer will have a flag raised for him behind his back, and it will be said, 'This is the betrayal ofso-and-so, the son of so-and-so .'s* 11 Concerning Allah's statement, iThen he will have no} meaning, man on the Day ofJudgement. }any power} meaning, within himself. m Al-Bukharino . 6177, 6178, and Muslim 3 :1359.

itior any helper.) meaning, from other than himself. This statement means that he will not be able to save himself from the torment of Allah, and nor will anyone else be able to save him. " ,gp)' ou Cj 3\$ / Si 4\$ 3 42 J. By the sky which gives rain, again and again.) ill. And the earth which splits.) il3. Verily, this is the Word that separates.) And it is not a thingfor amusement.) 415. Verily, they are but plotting a plot.) 416. And I am planning a plan.) 417. So, give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with thanfor a while.) Swearing to the Truthfulness of the Qur'an and the Failure ofThoseWho oppose it Ibn 'Abbas said, "Ar-raf means rain." It has also been narrated from him that he said, "It means the clouds that contain rain." He also said, *6m m At-Tabari 24:360.

iBy the sky (having rain clouds) which gives rain, again and again.} "This means that it rains and then it rains (again)." Qatadah said, "It returns the sustenance of the servants (creatures) every year. Were it not for this, they would all be destroyed and so would their cattle. " * 1 iAnd the earth which splits.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Splitting to bring forth plant growths. " *2 * This was also said by Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.13 * Concerning Allah's statement, ® 'h> 4Verily, this is the Word that separates .} Ibn 'Abbas said (Fast is), "True." *4 * Qatadah also said the same. Someone else said, "A just ruling." \$o }And it is not a thingfor amusement.} meaning, rather it is serious and true. Then Allah informs about the disbelievers saying that they reject Him and hinder others :rom His path. Allah says, *4. Pi iVerily, they are but plotting a plot.} meaning, they plot against the people in their calling them to oppose the Qur'an. Then Allah says, \$} iSo, give a respite to the disbelievers;} meaning, wait for them and do not be in haste concerning them. ideal gently with them far a while.} meaning, a little while. This At-Tabari 24:360. * At-Tabari 24:361. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :477 ' At-Tabari 24 :362

443Surah 86. At-Tariq (11-17) (Part-301 means that you will see what befalls them of torment, punishment and destruction. This is as Allah says, iWe let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment. (31:24)

Surah 87: Al-Ala

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6390–6400]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Sabbih" (Chapter - 87) Which was revealed in Makkah The Virtues of Surat Al-Ala This Surah was revealed in Makkah before the migration to Al-Madinah. The proof of this is what Al-Bukhari recorded from Al-Bara' bin 'Azib, that he said, "The first people to come to us (in Al-Madinah) from the Companions of the Prophet were Mus'ab bin T'mayr and Ibn Umm Maktum, who taught us the Qur'an; then 'Ammar, Bilal and Sa'd came. Then T'mar bin Al-Khattab came with a group of twenty people, after which the Prophet ﷺ came. I have not seen the people of Al-Madinah happier with anything more than their happiness with his coming (to Al-Madinah). This was reached to such an extent that I saw the children and little ones saying, This is the Messenger of Allah who has come.' Thus, he came, but he did not come until after I had already recited (i.e., learned how to recite) ? r : "i" gs-) iGlorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} (87:1) as well as other Surahs similar to it." 2' It has been confirmed in the Two Sahths that the Messenger of Allah said to Mu'ddh, oWhy didn't you recite "Glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High," ; "By the sun and its brightness," and "By the night when it envelopes."n|31 This Surah is more commonly called Surat Al-A'ld. 121 Fath Al-Bari8 :569 •3| Fath Al-Bari1 :234 , and Muslim 1 :340

Imam Ahmad recorded from An-Nu'man bin Bashir that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ recited Surat Al-Ala (chapter 87) and Surat Al-Ghashiyah (chapter 88) in the two 'Id prayers. If the 'Id prayer fell on Friday, he would recite them in both prayers { 'Id and Salat Al-Jumu'ah). ,X1 Muslim also recorded this in his Sahih, as well as Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah. The wording of Muslim and the Sunan compilers says, "He used to recite 4*~£> £*:£- 4j&' \$P} Surat Al-Ala (chapter 87) and Surat Al-Gh&shiyah (chapter 88) for the two 'Ids and Jumu'ah. If they occurred on the same day, he would recite them in both of them." In his Musnad, Imam Ahmad recorded on the authority of Ubayy bin Ka*b, Abdullah bin 'Abbas, 'Abdur-Rahman bin Abza, and the Mother of the believers, 'A'ishah, that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to recite to£ Jih45&W foj<W& iGlorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} and iSay 'O you who disbelieve.} and iSay : 'He is Allah, the One.}' 'A'ishah added in her version that he would also recite the Mu'awwidhatayn (Al-Falaq and An-Mxs).12' i-sg* P In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, ftp SfjJ'j jJ» iS&j c£jl' JfSl' til*> jP J#% % 'to& c *1©*S*&JL @&K * fc0*3¥ 4 £*©£\$^ ©<£ Cj 4@<£ vjQ v ?@\$3t% fc 43 . Glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} 111 Ahmad 4:271. ,2* Ahmad from Ubayy 5:123, from Ibn 'Abbas 1 :299 , Ibn Abza 3 :406 and 'A'ishah 6 :227

42. Who has created, and then proportioned it. 43. And Who has measured; and then guided. 44. And Who brings out the pasturage, 45. And then makes it dark stubble.} 46. We shall make you recite, so

you shall not forget, 47. Except what Allah may will. He knows what is apparent and what is hidden. 48. And We shall make easy for you the easy 49. Therefore remind in case the reminder profits. 410. The reminder will be received by him who fears, 411. But it will be avoided by the wretched, 412. Who will enter the great Fire. 413. There he will neither die nor live.} The Command to pronounce Tasbeeh and its Response Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that whenever the Messenger of Allah ﷺ would recite if} 4Glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} he would say, 'Glory to my Lord, the Most High.' li Ibn Jarir recorded from Ibn Ishaq Al-Hamdani that whenever Ibn 'Abbas would recite f& if} 4Glorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} he would say, "Glory to my Lord, the Most High," and whenever he would recite ff ^} 41 swear by the Day of Resurrection.} (75:1) Ahmad 1 :232, Abu Dawud no. 883.

447 Surah 87. Al-A'la (1-13) (Part-30) and then reach the end of it 4^4\$ jA && jji S\$} iIs not He able to give life to the dead?} (75:40) he would say, "Glory to You, of course." * Qatadah said, ^£ iGlorify the Name of your Lord, the Most High.} "It has been mentioned to us that whenever the Prophet of Allah ﷺ used to recite it he would say, ^ij jIAlw 1 uGlorify to my Lord, the Most High/i.»"*2' The Creation, the Decree, and the bringing forth of Vegetation Allah says, iWho has created, and then proportioned it.} meaning, He created that which has been created, and He fashioned every creation in the best of forms. Then Allah says, \$And Who has measured; and then guided.} Mujahid said, "He guided man to distress and happiness, and he guided the cattle to their pastures."*3 ' This Ayah is similar to what Allah has said about Musa's statement to Fir'aun, Y /iL. Cfjj> tyf 40«r Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright.} (20:50) meaning, He decreed a set measure and guided the creation to it. This is just as is confirmed in Sahih Muslim on the 111 At-Tabari 24:367. * At-Tabari 24:368. This is based upon the narration of Ibn 'Abbas above *31 At-Tabari 24:369.

so you shall not forget, is, "do not forget" and that which would be abrogated, is merely an exception to this. Meaning, 'do not forget what We teach you to recite, except what Allah wills, which He removes and there is no sin on your leaving it off (not retaining it).' Concerning Allah's statement, ts 'j& %. iHe knows what is apparent and what is hidden. meaning, He knows what the creatures do openly and what they hide, whether it be statements or deeds. None of that is hidden from Him. Then Allah says, iAnd We shall make easy for you the easy meaning, *We will make good deeds and statements easy for you, and We will legislate such Law for you that is easy, tolerant, straight and just, with no crookedness, difficulty or hardship in it.' The Command to remind Allah then says, iTherefore remind in case the reminder profits.} meaning, remind where reminding is beneficial. From here we get the etiquette of spreading knowledge, that it should not be wasted upon those who are not suitable or worthy of it. The Commander of the believers, 'Ali said, "You do not tell people any statement that their intellects do not grasp except that it will be a Fitnah (trial) for some of them." He also said, "Tell people that which they know. Would you like for Allah and His Messenger to be rejected?" Allah said: iThe reminder will be received by him wlfears,} meaning, *he whose heart fears Allah and who knows that he is going to meet Him, will receive admonition from what you convey to him, O Muhammad.' y>t&. X> I ,

450 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iBut it will be avoided by the wretched, who will enter the great Fire. There he will neither die nor live.} meaning, he will not die and thus be allowed to rest, nor will he live a life that is beneficial to him. Instead, his life will be harmful to him, because it will be the cause of his feeling of

the pain of torment and various types of punishments what he is being punished with. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Said that the Messenger of Allah said, 4)1 Jjy I iMj 'ij liyyjj V l^JUi jliJl Jjfcf lil® ~ JULijI jdll J> U-jJl I : Jli j 1 : Jli ji ^ s11>J 1 : Jli _*l iUAJI • <Jli *1>J 1 oCj jj~® — 1Concerning the people of the Fire who are deserving of it, they will not die nor will they live. Regarding the people that Allah wants mercy for, He will cause them to die in the Fire. Then He will allow the intercessors to come to them, and a man will take his groups of supporters and plant them (or he said they will be planted) in the River of Al-Haya (or he said Al-Hayah, or Al-Hayawan, or Nahr Al-Jannah). Then they will sprout up like the sprouting of the seed on the moist bank of a flowing streams Then the Prophet^ said, 4 i\jSL^P |J 4*1_r*a»- l >%jll jyy Ul® »Haven't you all seen tlt e tree that is green, then it turns yellow, then it turns green (again)?u Abu Said then said that some of those present said, “It is as if the Prophet jg used to live in the desert wilderness (i.e., due to his parables of nature). ”* 11 Ahmad also recorded from Abu Said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, tj&J lj liyyv V |*^j)i tftfcf jjjJl I Jjd til bj u Alii) - pAUUaio : Jli j\ - jlljl - Jli L5 jl m Ahmad 3 :5 .

j\£\ \£ >;ip. 2 ^ 0j£j 4—>«J i «Concerning the people of the Fire who will be dwellers of it, they will not die in it nor will they live. However, there will be a group of people - or as he said - whom the Fire will bum due to their sins - or he said - their wrongdoings. So, He will cause them to die until they become burnt coal. Then the intercession will be allowed and they will be brought group after group, and they will be scattered over the rivers of Paradise. Then it will be said: “O people of Paradise! Pour down upon them.” Then they will sprout like the growing of the seed that is upon the moist bank of theflowing stream.” Then, a man from among the people present said, “It is as if the Messenger of Allah jg used to live in the desert wilderness.”111 Muslim also recorded this Hadith, ir v*\$'j o/jiy j? 'P*3 414. Indeed whosoever purifies himselfshall achieve success.} 415. And remembers the Name of his Lord, and performs Salah .} 416. Rather you prefer the life of this world.} 417. Although the Hereafter is better and more lasting.} 418. Verily, this is in theformer Scriptures} 419. The Scriptures ofIbrahim and Musa.} A Statement concerning the People ofSuccess Allah says, 4Indeed whosoever purifies himselfshall achieve success.} meaning, he purifies himself from despised characteristics and he follows what Allah has revealed to die Messenger 111 Ahmad 3:11. Muslim 1 :172.

nt 4And remembers the Name ofhis Lord, and performs Salah.} meaning, he establishes the prayer in its appointed time, seeking the pleasure of Allah, obedience to His command, and implementation of His Law. We have already reported from the Commander of the believers, ‘Umar bin ‘Abdul-'AzIz, that he used to command the people to give the Sadaqat Al-Fitr, and he would recite this Ayah: 2% £D& * '\$ iln indeed whosoever purifies himself slmll achieve success. And remembers the Name ofhis Lord, and performs Salah.} Abu Al-Ahwas said, “If someone comes to any of you begging, and he wants to pray, then he should give charity (Zakah) before he prays. For verily, Allah the Exalted says, iln indeed whosoever purifies himself shall achieve success. And remembers the Name ofhis Lord, and performs Salah.yM Qatadah said concerning this Ayah, S & iln indeed whosoever purifies himself shall achieve success. And remembers the Name of his Lord, and performs Saldh (Fasalla).} “He purifies his wealth and pleases his Creator, ”t3 ' ThisWorld is Worthless inComparison to the Hereafter Then Allah says, Gilt ;£Jt & iRather you prefer the life of this world.} meaning, *you give it precedence over the matter of the Hereafter, and you prefer it because of what it contains of 111 The prescribed charity at the end ofthe month ofRamadan Af-Tabari 24:374. At-Tabari 24:374.

usefulness and benefit for you in livelihood, and your returns (i.e., income, profitable gain).’ iAlthough the Hereafter is better and more lasting. meaning, the reward of the final abode is better than the worldly life, and it is more lasting. For indeed, this worldly life is lowly and temporal, whereas the Hereafter is noble and eternal. Thus, how can an intelligent person prefer that which is short-lived over that which is eternal. How can he give importance to that which will soon pass away from him, while ignoring the importance of the abode of eternity and infinity. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Musa Al-Ash‘ari that the Messenger of Allah jg said, A* ^ ‘»d.L S-® 4^ lA'j 'ii's'A. «Whoever loves his worldly life, will suffer in his Hereafter, and whoever loves his Hereafter, will suffer in his worldly life. Therefore, chose that which is everlasting over that which is temporals Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith.^ The Scriptures of Ibrahim and Musa Allah then says, 4^{yyj fglil '4* liu iVerily, this is in the former Scriptures - the Scriptures of Ibrahim and Musa.) This Ayah is similar to Allah’s statement in Surat An-Najm, ‘f '-Ky As*-*A U ‘Il ol> iOr is he not informed with what is in the Scriptures of Musa. I1 ' Ahmad 4:412. This Hadith has a deficiency in the chain of narration

And of Ibrahim who fulfilled (or conveyed) all that (Allah ordered him to do or convey): that no burdened person (with sins) shall bear the burden (sins) of another. And that man can have nothing but what he does. And that his deeds will be seen. Then he will be recompensed with a full and the best recompense. And that to your Lord is the End (Return of everything).\$ (53:36-42) And so forth, until the end of these Ay&t. Abu ‘Aliyah said, “The story of this Surah is in the earlier Scriptures.” ' Ibn Jarir preferred the view that the meaning of Allah’s statement. 4Verily, this\$ is referring to His previous statement, Jr OjJriJ3 j; ->& y} i>* d»' ilnecld whosoever purifies himself shall achieve success. And remembers the Name of his Lord, and offers Salah. Rather you prefer the life of this world. Although the Hereafter is better and more lasting. Then Allah says, iVerily, this meaning, the content of this discussion, iin the former Scriptures, the Scriptures of Ibrahim and Musa.y2' This view that he (At-Tabari) has chosen is good and strong. Similar to it has been reported from Qatadah and Ibn Zayd.131 And Allah knows best.

Surah 88: Al-Ghashiyah

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6401]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-Ghashiyah (Chapter - 88)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6401–6412]

Reciting Surat Al-A'la and Al-Ghashiyah in the Friday Prayer It has already been mentioned on the authority of An-Nu'man bin Bashir that the Messenger of Allah jgg used to recite Surat Al-A'la (87) and Al-Ghashiyah in the 'Id and Friday prayers. Imam Malik recorded that Ad-Dahhak bin Qays asked An- Nu'man bin Bashir, "What else did the Messenger of Allah sg recite on Friday along with Surat Al-Jumu'ah?" An-Nu'man replied, "Al-Ghashiyah (88). ""2 * This narration has been recorded by Abu Dawud, An-Nasal, Muslim and Ibn Majah. J-sg* P *- In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 0U £*&& 41. Has there come to you the narration of Al-Ghashiyah (the overwhelming)?} 42. Somefaces that Day will be Khashi'ah.) 43 . Laboring, weary. 44. They will enter into Fire, Hamiyah 45. They will be given to drink from a boiling (Aniyah) spring,> 46. Nofood will there befor them butfrom Dar?,\$ ' Muslim 2:598. 121 Al-Muwatta' 1 :U1 ' Abu Dawud 1 :670, An-Nasal 3:112, Muslim 2 :598 and Ibn Majah

456 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 47. Which will neither nourish nor avail against hunger.

The Day of Judgement and what will happen to the People ofthe Fire during it Al-Ghashiyah is one of the names of the Day of Judgement. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd.' ' It has been called this because it will overwhelm the people and overcome them. Allah then says, wi iSome faces that Day will be Khashi'ah.} meaning, humiliated. This was said by Qatadah.121 Ibn 'Abbas said, "They will be humble but this action will be of no benefit to them." Then Allah says. iLaboring, weary\$ meaning, they did many deeds and became weary in their performance, yet they will be cast into a blazing Fire on the Day of Judgement. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Burqani narrated from Abu Imran Al-Jawni that he said, " 'Umar bin Al-Khattab passed by the monastery of a monk and he said: 'O monk!' Then the monk came out, and Umar looked at him and began to weep. Then it was said to him: 'O Commander of the faithful! Why are you weeping?' He replied: 1 remembered the statement ofAllah, the Mighty and Majestic, in His Book, iLaboring, weary. They will enter into Fire, Hamiyah.} So that is what has made me cry.' "13i Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said. iLaboring, weary.} "The Christians.""41 It is narrated that Iknmah and As-Suddi both said, "Laboring in the worldly life with

disobedience, and weariness in the Fire from torment and At-Tabari 24:381. At-Tabari 24:382. 'Abdur-Razzaq 2 :299 , and Al-Hakim 2 :522 '4| FctthAl-Bari 8:570.

457 Surah 88. Al-Ghdshiyah (1-7) (Part-30) perdition." Ibn 'Abbas, Al-Hasan, and Qatadah all said, iS l*1* tlr^)They will enter into Fire, Hdmiyah) meaning, hot with intense heat. i&& iThey will be given to drink from a boiling (Aniyah) spring.) meaning, its heat has reached its maximum limit and boiling point. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and As- SuddiJ ' Concerning Allah's statement, £S4t 4Nofood will there befor them butfrom Dari ,) 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "A tree from the Hellfire."121 Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Abu Al-Jawza' and Qatadah, all said, "It is Ash-Shibriq (a type of plant)." Qatadah said, "The Quraysh called it Ash-Shabraq in the spring and Ad-Dart in the summer." Ikrimah said, "It is a thorny tree which reaches down to the ground."131 Al-Bukhari related that Mujahid said, uAd-Dart is a plant that is called Ash-Shibriq. The people of the Hijaz call it Ad-Daft when it dries, and it is poisonous."141 Ma'marnarrated that Qatadah said,)Nofood will there befor them butfrom Dart,) "This is Ash-Shibriq. When it dries it is called Ad-Dart. Said narrated from Qatadah that he said,)Nofood will there befor them but Dart,) "This is of the worst, most disgusting and loathsome of foods."161 Concerning Allah's statement, 111 At-Tabari 24:383. At-Tabari 24 :385 At-Tabari 24:384. 141 Path Al-Bari 8 :570 . 151 At-Tabari 24:384. At-Tabari 24:384.

^ &mm e<u = eMa ^ x^, . .;> f * ->aTsspg*- c>; o 6*-* *r <>.v g aairca is v> /• / * */ _\y ay?"J A—^laj lti»JSa-ii!cSjji £s± ' , ^ ' /,'?*<&JI' f-'if i ^5^r »ulC'(j!Jl y— A~*vXjJ^£waj A.^ gbAt*^ **\$*>"" > *' 4* i'?U jUj^QA&y*0^i*Jly ij ^0%~z^ragr%0^ chtiKZl iWhich will neither nourish nor avail against hunger.) This means that the intent in eating it will not be achieved, and nothing harmful will be repelled by it. CP*^ ^yi *)£) *! ? f i'. UJC- ly-J ly-J £~> J»A> I". xr* lyj Ouf <VUj ® ?' •»>; &Jb 40&b& 45. Faces that Day will be joyful,) 49. G/ad ztn'fh their endeavor.) 420. In a lofty Paradise.) ill. Where they shall neither hear harmful speech nor falsehood.) 412. Therein will be a running spring.) 413. Therein will be thrones raised high.) 414. And cups set at hand.) 425. And Namariq, set in rows.) 426. And Zarabi, spread out (Mabthuthah.) The Condition of the People of Paradise on the Day of Judgement After mentioning the situation of the wretched people, Allah changes the discussion to mention those who will be happy. He says,

iFaces that Day.} meaning, on the Day of Judgement. iwill be joyful,} meaning, pleasure will be noticeable in them (those faces). This will only occur due to their striving. Sufyan said, 4Glad with their endeavor.} "They will be pleased with then- deeds."Then Allah says, H & 4} 4In a lofty Paradise.} meaning, elevated and brilliant, secure in their dwellings. iWhere they shall neither hear harmful speech nor falsehood.} meaning, they will not hear in the Paradise that they will be in, any foolish word. This is as Allah says, \0 fe j} iThey shall not hear therein any LaghwJ 1! but only Salam.} (19:62) Allah also says, 4\$ P 'fa iFree from any Laghw, and free from sin.} (52:23) and He says, ^ iJl 50 ^!U^ % (Jife v} 4No Laghw will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: "Salam! Salam!" } (56:25-26) Then Allah continues, Vain, useless, false, sinful speech.

462 Surah 88. Al-Ghashivah (17-26) (Part-30) r Si 02Vr CSK @>§ 417. Do they not look at the camels, how they are created?} 418. And at the heaven, how it is raised?} 419. And at the mountains, how they are rooted?} 420. And at the earth, how it is outspread?} 421. So remind them - you are only one who

reminds. 422. You are not a Musaytir over them.} 423. Save the one who turns away and disbelieves.} 424. Then Allah will punish him with the greatest punishment.} 425. Verily, to Us will be their return;} 426. Then verily, for Us will be their reckoning.} The Exhortation to look at the Creation of the Camel, the Heaven, the Mountains and the Earth Allah commands His servants to look at His creations that prove His power and greatness. He says. 4Do they not look at the camels, how they are created?} Indeed it is an amazing creation, and the way it has been fashioned is strange. For it is extremely powerful and strong, yet gentle, carrying heavy loads. It allows itself to be guided by a weak rider. It is eaten, benefit is derived from its hair, and its milk is drunk. They are reminded of this because the most common domestic animal of the Arabs was the camel. Shurayh Al-Qadi used to say, “Come out with us so that we may look at the camels and how they were created, and at the sky and how it has been raised.” Meaning, how Allah raised it in such magnificence above the ground. This is as Allah says, aiQtj Cfej^5-. SS' Xpj \ 0} 4Have they not looked at the heaven above them, how we have made it and adorned it and there are no rifts on it?} (50:6)

462 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Then Allah says, 4\$ 4And at the mountains, how they are rooted?} meaning, how they have been erected. For indeed they are firmly affixed so that the earth does not sway with its dwellers. And He made them with the benefits and minerals they contain. JT 4And at the earth, how it is outspread?} meaning, how it has been spread out, extended and made smooth. Thus, He directs the bedouin to consider what he himself witnesses. His camel that he rides upon, the sky that is above his head, the mountain that faces him, and the earth that is under him, all of this is proof of the power of the Creator and Maker of these things. These things should lead him to see that He is the Lord, the Most Great, the Creator, the Owner, and the Controller of everything. Therefore, He is the God other than Whom none deserves to be worshipped. The Story of Dimam bin Tha'labah These are the things Dimam swore by after questioning the Messenger of Allah jg. This can be seen in what Imam Ahmad recorded from Thabit, who reported that Anas said, “We were prohibited from asking the Messenger of Allah ^ anything. Thus, it used to amaze us when an intelligent man from the people of the desert (bedouin Arabs) would come and ask him about something while we were listening. So a man from the people of the desert came and said, ‘O Muhammad! Verily, your messenger has come to us and he claims that you claim that Allah sent you.’ He (the Prophet) jg said, •He told the truths The man said, “Who created the heaven?” He (the Prophet |g) replied, aAllah. The man said, Who created the earth?” He (the Prophet jg) replied, «S3il», The man said, Who erected these mountains and placed in them whatever is in them?” He (the Prophet M) replied, •an, *AllahK

463 Surah 88. Al-Ghashiuah (17-26) <Part-30 Then the man said, “By the One Who created the heaven, the earth, and erected these mountains, did Allah send you?” He (the Prophet 2g) said, “Yes.» The man then said, Your messenger claims that we are obligated to pray five prayers during our day and night.’ He (the Prophet jg) said, “He told the truthJ The man then said, “By HeWho has sent you, did Allahcommandyou with this?”He (the Prophet j\$) replied, “Yes.s> The man then said, Your messenger also claims that we are obligated to give charity from our wealth.’ He (the Prophet M) said, “He told the truth. » Then the mam said, “By He Who has sent you, did Allah command you with this?” He (the Prophet ig) replied, r“ “Yes.” The man then said, Your messenger claims that we are obligated to perform pilgrimage (Hajj) to the House (the Ka'bah), for whoever is able to find away there.’He (the Prophet jg) said, “He told the truth. Then the man turned away to leave while saying, “By He Who has

sent you with the truth, I will not add anything to these things and I will not decrease anything from them.' The Prophet ﷺ then said, $\text{Ju}\text{£} > \text{tlf}$ he has spoken truthfully, he will certainly enter Paradise, d111 U) Ahmad 3 :143.

Then he yg recited, $\wedge \text{Si T3| i}$ So remind them - you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them - $\wedge$ This is how Muslim recorded this Hadith in his Book of Faith, and At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal also recorded it in their Sunans in the Books of TafstrJ2 ' This Hadith can be found in both of the Two Sahihsi131 The Threat forWhoever turns away from the Truth Concerning Allah's statement, iSave the one who turns away and disbelieves. meaning, he turns away from acting upon its pillars, and he disbelieves in the truth with his heart and his tongue. This is similar to Allah's statement, $\& \text{Si}\text{£a}\& \text{i}$ So he neither believed nor prayed! But on the contrary, he belied and him away!} (75:31-32) Thus, Allah says, $\text{c}\&\text{n it i:zi}$ } iThen Allah will punish him with the greatest punishment.} Allah then says, 'cj'i 4Verily , to Us will be their return;} meaning, their place of return and their resort. $\wedge 4 \text{ft i}$ Then verily, for Us will be their reckoning.} meaning, We will 111 Ahmad 3:300. Muslim 1 :53, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:265, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra FathAl-Bari 1 :95, from Ibn Umar, and Muslim 1 :52.

reckon their deeds for them and requite them for those deeds.' If they did good, they will receive good, and if they did evil, they will receive evil.

Surah 89: Al-Fajr

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Opening

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Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-Fajr (Chapter - 89)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6413–6427]

Recitation of SuratAl-Fajrin the Prayer An-Nasal recorded a narration from Jabir that Mu'adh prayed a prayer and a man came and joined him in the prayer. Mu'adh made the prayer long, so the man went and prayed (alone) at the side of the Masjid, and then left. When Mu'adh was informed of this he said, “(He is) a hypocrite.” He (Mu'adh) then informed the Messenger of Allah of what happened. The Prophet then asked the young man (about it) and he replied, “O Messenger of Allah! I came to pray with him, but he made the prayer too long for me. So I left him and prayed at the side of the Masjid. Then I went to feed my she-camel.” The Messenger of Allah then said, 4'^^ 0^.\$ ^} 'oi^ if) “Are you causing trouble Mu'adh? Why don't you recite 4'Glorify the Name of your Lord the Most High', 4'By the sun and its brightness', 4'By the dawn', and 4'By the night as it envelops'?}^ In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 4 p& 4 £ h&0M 0^ jo; 4 Sk \$\$ 0>£\$ fSi0& 5\$0jz & 04\$ 4 '&> y» « %% i \y£ '4\ ii] An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:55.

By the daunt;} 42. And by the ten nights,} 43. And by the even and the odd.} 44. And by the night when it departs.} 45. Is there (not) in them sufficient proofs for men of understanding!} 46. Saw you not how your Lord dealt with 'Ad?} 47. Iram of the pillars,} 48. The like ofwhich were not created in the land?} 49. And Thamud, who hewed out rocks in the valley?} 410. And Fir'awn with Al-Awtad?} 411. Who did transgress beyond bounds in the lands.} 412. And made therein much mischief.} 423. So, your Lord poured on them different kinds of severe torment.} 424. Verily, your Lord is Ever Watchful.} The Explanation ofAl-Fajrandwhat comes after it Concerning Al-Fajr, it is well known that it is the morning. This was said by 'Ali, Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Mujahid and As- Suddi.' It has been reported from Masraq and Muhammad bin Ka*b that Al-Fajr refers to the day of Sacrifice (An-Nahr) in particular, and it is the last of the ten nights.'21 The ten nights' refers to the (first) ten days of Dhul-Hijjah. This was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Ibn Zubayr, Mujahid and others among the Salaf and the latter generations.'3 ' It has been confirmed in Sahih Al-Bukhari from Ibn 'Abbas that the Prophet^ said, {jt rfct 4)1 JJ JaaJI j>UI {jA Ud “There are no days in which righteous deeds are more beloved to Allah than these daysj Af-Tabari 24 :395 , and Al-Baghawi 4 :481 [2' Al-Qurjubi 20:39. At-Tabari 24:396.

469 Surah 89. Al-Fair (1-14) (Part-30) meaning the ten days of Dhul-Hijjah. They said, “Not even fighting Jihad in the way of Allah?” He replied, iri ‘jlil Jtr- ^_>® •Not even Jihad in the way of Allah; except for a man who goes out (for Jihad) with his self and his wealth, and he does not return with any of that. Allah then says, mm ***> iAnd by the even and the odd.} It has been mentioned in a Hadith that Al-Watr (the odd) is the day of ‘Arafah because it falls on the ninth, and Ash-Shafi (the even) is the day of An-Nahr (sacrifice) because it falls on the tenth day.*21 This was also said by Ibn ‘Abbas, Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak.*3 ' There are also other opinions about the explanation of these two words. Explanation of Night Concerning Allah’s statement, iAnd by the night when it departs.} Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, “When it goes away.”*4 ' ‘Abdullah bin Zubayr said, iAnd by the night when it departs.} “As some parts of it remove other parts of it.”*5 ' Mujahid, Abu Al-‘Aliyah, Qatadah, and Malik who reported it from Zayd bin Aslam and Ibn Zayd, they all said; 111 Fath Al-Bari2:530. The Hadith in question is unauthentic. At-Tabari 24 :397 , 398 ' Al-Tabari 24 :401 At-Tabari 24 :401

iAnd by the night when it departs. “When it moves along.”***' Concerning Allah’s statement, p 4 iThere is indeed in them sufficient proofs for men with Hijr!} meaning, for he who possesses intellect, sound reasoning, understanding and religious discernment. The intellect has only been called Hijr because it prevents the person from doing that which is not befitting of him of actions and statement. From this we see the meaning of Hijr Al-BayP because it prevents the person performing Tawaffrom clinging the wall facing Ash-Sham. Also the term Hijr Al-Yamamah (the cage of the pigeon) is derived from this meaning (i.e. prevention). It is said, “Hajara Al-Hakim so-and-so (The judge passed a judgement preventing so-and-so),” when his judgement prevents the person from his liberty (i.e., of freely utilizing his wealth). Allah says, ft. iAnd they will say: "Hijr MahjSr."^ (25:22) All of these examples are different cases but their meanings are quite similar. The oath that is referred to here is about the times of worship and the acts of worship themselves, such as Hajj, Salah and other acts of worship that Allah’s pious, obedient, servants who fear Him and are humble before Him, seeking His Noble Face, perform in order to draw nearer to Him. Mentioning the Destruction of ‘Ad After mentioning these people, and their worship and obedience, Allah says, iSaw you not how your Lord dealt with 'Ad?} 'At-Tabari 24:401. ' The area on the northern side of the Ka'bah that is a walled-in precinct. ' Meaning, completely shunned.

472 Surah 89. Al-Fajr (1-14) (Part-30) These were people who were rebellious, disobedient, arrogant, outside of His obedience, deniers of His Messengers and rejectors of His Scriptures. Thus, Allah mentions how He destroyed them, annihilated them and made them legends to be spoken of and an exemplaiy lesson of warning. He says, 4Saw you not how your Lord dealt with ‘Ad? Iram of the pillars,} These were the first people of ‘Ad. They were the descendants of ‘Ad bin Iram bin ‘Aws bin Sam bin NUh. This was said by Ibn Ishaq.’ 11 They are those to whom Allah sent His Messenger Hdd. However, they rejected and opposed him. Therefore, Allah saved him and those who believed with him from among them, and He destroyed others with a furious, violent wind. Ji* it’lr* JtJ ‘jCj>CL.} 4Which Allah imposed on them for seven nights and eight days in succession, so that you could see men lying overthrown, as if they were hollow trunks of date palms! Do you see any remnants of them?} (69:7-8) Allah mentioned their story in the Qur’an in more than one place, so that the believers may learn a lesson from their demise. Allah then says, 4Iram of the pillars.} This is an additional explanation that

adds clarification who they actually were. Concerning His saying, 4 of the pillars.} is because they used to live in trellised houses that were raised with firm pillars. They were the strongest people of their time in their physical stature, and they were the mightiest people in power. Thus, Hud reminded them of this m At-Tabari 24 :404

blessing, and he directed them to use this power in the obedience of their Lord Who had created them. He said, tfi; to: 4 -m it i And remember that He made you successors after the people of Niih and increased you amply in stature. So remember the graces from Allah so that you may be successful.^(7:69) Allah also said, it dSt !£ JJ i!. lit 4 As for 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?" See they not that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them.)(41:15} And Allah says here, 4 <3k£ ?& 4 The like of which were not created in the land?) meaning, there had been none created like them in their land, due to their strength, power and their great physical stature. Mujahid said, "Iram was an ancient nation who were the first people of 'Ad." Qatadah bin Di'amah and As-Suddi both said, "Verily, Iram refers to the House of the kingdom of 'Ad." This latter statement is good and strong. Concerning Allah's statement, 4 <Sk \$ Jf) 4 The like of which were not created in the land?) Ibn Zayd considered the pronoun of discussion here to refer to the pillars, due to their loftiness. He said, "They built pillars among the hills, the likes of which had not been constructed in their land before." However, Qatadah and Ibn Jarir m At-Jabari 24 : 406

considered the pronoun of discussion to refer to the tribe (of 'Ad), meaning that there was no tribe that had been created like this tribe in the land - meaning during their time.' 11 And this latter view is the correct position. The saying of Ibn Zayd and those who follow his view is a weak one, because if He intended that, He would have said "The like of which were not produced in the land." But He said: iThe like of which were not created in the land.} Then Allah says, 4 tj 4\$ jj i And Thamud, who hewed (Jabii) rocks in the valley?} meaning, they cut the rocks in the valley. Ibn 'Abbas said, "They carved them and they hewed them.",2) This was also said by Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Zayd.131 From this terminology it is said (in the Arabic language), "the hewing of leopard skin" when it is tom, and "The hewing of a garment" when it is opened. The word Jayb' (pocket or opening in a garment) also comes from Jdbu. Allah says, i And you hew in the mountains, houses with great skill } (26:149) A Mention of Fir'awn Allah then says, i And Fir'awn with Al-Awtdd?} Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Al-Awtdd are At-Tabari 24:406. At-Tabari 24:408. At-Tabari 24:408.

the armies who enforced his commands for him." * It has also been said that Fir'awn used to nail their hands and their feet into pegs (Awtad) of iron that he would hang them from. A similar statement was made by Mujahid when he said, "He used to nail the people (up) on pegs."121 Sa'id bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan and As-Suddi all said the same thing.'3' Allah said, i Who did transgress beyond bounds in the lands. And made therein much mischief. meaning, they rebelled, were arrogant, and went about making corruption in the land, and harming the people. -by*" i So, your Lord poured on them different kinds of severe torment.} meaning, He sent down a torment upon them from the sky and caused them to be overcome by a punishment that could not be repelled from the people who were criminals. The Lord is Ever Watchful Concerning Allah's statement, 4 Verily, your Lord is Ever Watchful.} Ibn 'Abbas said, "He hears and He sees."14' This means that He watches over His creation in that which they do, and He

will reward them in this life and in the Hereafter based upon what each of them strove for. He will bring all of the creation before Him and He will judge them with justice. He will requit each of them with that which he deserves, for He is far removed from injustice and tyranny. I1 ' At-Taoari 24:409. I2 ' At-Tabari 24:409. ' At-Tabari 24:409. ' At-Tabari 24:411.

'emm mm >.r-r r ,<rx/VJ l* lij L&? */ V? Jj5j /U*Sj yUjS U ^ J# d in Ctj *££>. -t*/? •»;* -v 4>v /jjj % s/p ^ i^ JU. ^lil H£=>1 415. As for man, when his Lord tries him by giving him honor and bounties, then he says: "My Lord has honored me 416. But when He tries him by straitening his means of life, he says: "My Lord has humiliated me!"} 0p*5^i0 3r^Qj ji^ 4a0sc2Kfe!£s5%#fijt)5ayt ^ ^3i~<eSfi£<3.4&S0*4\>#pAS& 0d-i&JSiJi^JUsoo^Ji 417. But no! But you treat not the orphans with kindness and generosity!} 418. And urge not one another on the feeding of the Miskin!} 419. And you devour the Turath - devouring with greed.} 420. And you love wealth with love Jamma.} Wealth and Poverty are both a Test and Honor or Disgrace for the Servant Allah refutes man in his belief that if Allah gives Him abundant provisions to test him with it, it is out of His honor for him. But this is not the case, rather it is a trial and a test, as Allah says.

476 Tafsir Von Kathir 4Do they think that in wealth and children with which We enlarge them. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} (23:55-56) Likewise, from another angle, if Allah tests him and tries him by curtailing his sustenance, he believes that is because Allah is humiliating him. As Allah says, 4But no!} meaning, the matter is not as he claims, neither in this nor in that. For indeed Allah gives wealth to those whom He loves as well as those whom He does not love. Likewise, He withholds sustenance from those whom He loves and those whom He does not love. The point is that Allah should be obeyed in either circumstance. If one is wealthy, he should thank Allah for that, and if he is poor, he should exercise patience. From the Evil that the Servant does regarding Wealth Allah said, ^ J iBut you treat not the orphans with kindness and generosity!} This contains the command to honor him (the orphan). Abu Dawud recorded from Sahl bin Said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, •a^i j, jitfj u» tThe guardian of the orphan and I will be like these two in Paradise .» And he put his two fingers together - the middle finger and the index finger. 1 ' 'jj} 4And urge not one another on the feeding of the Miskin!} meaning, they do not command that the poor and the needy be treated with kindness, nor do they encourage each other to do so. ***' Abu Dawud 5 :356, similar with Muslim no. 2983

\$And you devour the Turath meaning, the inheritance. 4devouring with greed.} meaning, however they can get it, whether lawful or forbidden. iAnd you love wealth with love Jamma.} meaning, in abundance. This increases some of them in their wickedness. 3%0. em&&0 & rH%> ^ ii& \$4& ^44 Jyj ^ jlj o£\$ft %=>'& j_i'j «ifj d', CRTft ^£^211 jlai (Jc\£_ f|| jJ Sfj \$JU.1 Jr»i> 4 4^3 Nay! When the earth is flattened, Dakkan Dakka.} 422. And your Lord comes with the angels in rows.} 423. And Hell will be brought near that Day. On that Day will man remember, but how will that remembrance avail him?} 424. He will say: "Alas! Would that I had sent forth for my life!"} 425. So on that Day none will punish as He will punish.} 426. And none will bind as He will bind.} 427. "O tranquil soul!"} 428. "Come back to your Lord, - well-pleased and well- pleasing!"} 429. "Enter then among My servants,"} 430. "And enter My Paradise!"} OxttheDayofJudgementEveryone willberecompensed according to what He

did of Good or Evil Allah informs of what will happen on the Day of Judgement of the great horrors. He says, in

iNay!} meaning, truly. iWhen the earth is flattened, Dakkan Dakka.} meaning, the earth and the mountains will be flattened, leveled and made even, and the creatures will rise from their graves for their Lord. 4And your Lord comes^ meaning, for the session of Judgement between His creatures. This is after they requested the best of the Sons of Adam - Muhammad jg - to intercede with Allah. This will occur only after they have requested the other great Messengers, one after another. Yet, all of them will say, "I cannot do that for you." This will continue until the beseech- ing of the men reaches Muhammad and he will say, "I will do it, I will do it." So he will go and seek to intercede with Allah as the session of Judgement will have come, and Allah will allow him to intercede for that (the Judgement).¹¹¹ This will be the first of the intercessions, and it is the praiseworthy station that has already been discussed in Surat Subhan (Al-Isra'). So Allah will come for the session of Judgement as He wills, and the angels will also come, lined up in rows upon rows before Him. Then Allah says, 4^4% fry. 4And Hell will be brought near that Day.} In his Sahlh, Imam Muslim bin Al-Hajjaj recorded that 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, will by^4 \$ xUy ('Jji «Hell will be brought on near that Day and it will have seventy thousand leashes, and each leash will have seventy twusand angels pulling if. s'21 At-Tirmidhi also recorded the same narration ' Allah said: ¹¹¹ Ahmad 1 :282. ,2! MusUm 4:2184. ^ TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 7 :294

40n that Day will man remember,} meaning, his deeds, and what he did before in his past and recent times. 4but how will that remembrance avail him?} meaning, how can remembrance then benefit him? iXxi will say : "Alas! Would that I had sentforth for my life!"} meaning, if he was a disobedient person, he will be sorry for the acts of disobedience he committed. If he was an obedient person, he will wish that he performed more acts of obdedience. This is similar to what Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded from Muhammad bin Abi 'Amirah, who was one of the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg. He said, "If a servant fell down on his face (in prostration) from the day that he was bom until the day he died as an old man, in obedience to Allah, he would scorn this act on the Day of Judgement. He would wish to be returned to this life so that he could earn more reward and compensation. Allah then says, 4So on that Day none will punish as He will punish.} meaning, there is no one more severely punished than those whom Allah punishes for disobeying Him. 4And none will bind as He will bind.} meaning, there is no one who is more severely punished and bound than those the Az- Zabaniyah punish¹² ' the disbelievers in their Lord. This is for the criminals and the wrongdoers among the creatures. In reference to the pure and tranquil soul - which is always at rest m Ahmad 4:185. [21 These are the angels of punishment in the Hellfire . See Surat Al- •Alaq.

480 Tafslr Ibn Kathir and abiding by the truth — it will be said to it, d! CB? <0 tranquil soul! Come back to your Lord.) meaning, to His company, His reward and what He has prepared for His servants in His Paradise. iwell-pleased) meaning, within itself. iwell-pleasing.) meaning, pleased with Allah, and He will be pleased with it and gratify it. iEnter then among My servants,) meaning, among their ranks. :i ME- j {And enter My Paradise!} This will be said to it at the time of death and on the Day of Judgement. This is like the angels giving glad tiding to the believer at his time of death and when he rises from his grave. Likewise is this statement here. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ibn 'Abbas

concerning Allah's statement, 40 tranquil soul! Come back to your Lord, well-pleased and well-pleasing!) He said, "This Ayah was revealed while Abu Bakr was sitting (with the Prophet ﷺ). So he said, 'O Messenger of Allah! There is nothing better than this!' The Prophet ﷺ then replied, *dljla >il3 JULi <ol Lb a*This will indeed be said to you. 1 "1 This is the end of the Tafslr of Surat Al-Fajr, and all praise and blessings are due to Allah. l'l ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Marduyah, and Ad-Diya' Al-Maqdisi in Al-Mukht&rah . See Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8:513.

The Tafslr of SuratAl-Balad (Chapter - 90)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6427–6437]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. j Cj Jijj utg Cp-£jf ^ s J4^ :p'4#^ ^ j j^ olij IJ.vn^aUAj liUlJj ^ ' v 'jJ il . Nay! I swear by this city;} 42. And you are free in this city.} 43. And by the begetter and that which he begot.} 44. Verily, We have created man in Kabad.} 45. Does he think that none can overcome him?} 46. He says: "I have wasted wealth in abundance!"} 47. Does he think that none sees him?} 48. Have We not made for him two eyes?} 49. And a tongue and two lips?} 410. And shmon him the tioo ways?} Swearing by the Sanctity of Makkah and Other Things that Man was created in Hardship Here Allah has sworn by Makkah, the Mother of the Towns, addressing its resident (during the non-sacred months,) free in this city in order to draw his attention to the significance of its sanctity when its people are in the state of sanctity. Khusayf reported from Mujahid; 4Nay! I swear by this city;} "The word "La" (Nay) refers to the

refutation against them (Quraish). I swear by this city."111 Shablb bin Bishr narrated from Ikrimah, from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, i'Jp' U^r^ 'fy iNay! I swear by this city;) "This means Makkah." Concerning the Ayah: <*** fi •"J/V Jr -'jF yon are yree in fins ci/y.^ he (Ibn 'Abbas) said, "O Muhammad! It is permissible for you to fight in it."121 Similar was reported from Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Atiyah, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd . 131 Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, "Allah made it lawful (to fight in) for him (the Prophet ﷺ) for one hour of a day."141 The meaning of what they have said was mentioned in a Hadxth that is agreed- upon as being authentic. In it the Prophet said. JI 4ll y'jL Jii^ jo \& lu i fiji ApL* Ujlj Ji>>J VJ 0 V c . jUJ 1 JialiJl VilJj V I i —*VL Ul. ^fo I O-ilp JLfij « Verily, Allah made this city sacred on the Day that He created the heavens and the earth . Therefore, it is sacred by the sanctity of Allah until the Day of Judgement. Its trees slwuld not be uprooted, and its bushes and grasses slwuld not be removed. And it was only made lawful for me (to fight in) for one hour of a day. Today its sanctity has been restored just as it was sacred yesterday. So, let the one who is present inform those who are absent ,»'51 In another wording of this Hadith, he said, # * » ' | ' * { i J > - _ i + + S • jj! <u1 jl 1 3j}yts auI Jli^j j* jli® «So, if anyone tries to use the fighting of the Messenger (to 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8:517. 121 Al-Qurtubi 20 :60, and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 : 518. 131 Al-Qurtubi 20:60, and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :518. 141 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :518 Fath Al-Bari 4 :56

conquer Makkah) as an excuse (to fight there), then tell him that Allah permitted it for His Messenger and He has not permitted it for youV Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd by the begetter and that which

he begot.} Mujahid, Abu Salih, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Khusayf, Shurahbll bin Sa'd and others have said, "Meaning, by the begetter, Adam, and that which he begot is his children."121 This view that Mujahid and his companions have chosen is good and strong. This is supported by the fact that Allah swears by the Mother of the Towns, which are dwellings. Then after it He swears by the dwellers therein, who is Adam, the father of mankind, and his children. Abu 'Imran Al-Jawni said, "It refers to Ibrahim and his progeny." Ibn Jarir recorded this statement131 as did Ibn Abi Hatim. Ibn Jarir preferred the view that it is general and it refers to every father and his children. This meaning is also acceptable. 141 Allah then says, j ££•3} iVerily, We have created man in Kabad.} Ibn Abi Najih and Jurayj reported from 'Ata, from Ibn 'Abbas concerning the phrase 'in Kabad', "He was created while in hardship. Don't you see him?" Then he mentioned his birth and the sprouting of his teeth. 151 Mujahid said, iin Kabad.} "A drop of sperm, then a clot, then a lump of flesh, enduring in his creation." Mujahid then said, "This is similar to Allah's statement, 111 FathAl-BQri 1 :238. 121 Al-Qurtubi 20:61, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8:519, and At-Tabari At-Jabari 24 :433 At-Tabari 24 :433 At-Tabari 24:434.

4ti^r ow>u /W 4His mother bears him with lordship. And s/ie brings him forth with hardship.^(46:15) and she breast-feeds him with hardship, and his livelihood is a hardship. So he endures all of this." Said bin Jubayr said, 4Verily We have created man in Kabad.} "In hardship and seeking livelihood." Ikrimah said, "In hardship and long-suffer- ing." 11 ' Qatadah said, "In difficulty."*2 ' It is reported from Al-Hasan that he said, "Enduring the hardships of the world by life and the severity of the Hereafter." Man is encompassed by Allah and His Bounties Allah says, && '>& j J^} 4Does he think that none can overcome him?} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, && J JX%} iDoes he think that none can overcome him?} "Meaning no one is able to take his wealth." Qatadah said, iDoes he think that none can overcome him?} "The Son of Adam thinks that he will not be asked about this wealth of his - how he earned and how he spent it." ' Allah said: iXti -ft j>> 4He says: "I have wasted wealth in abundance!"} Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8:520. At-Tabari 24:433. At-Jabari 24:436.

This means, the Son of Adam says, "I spent an abundance of wealth." Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others have said this. [11 iMp% j5 ol^} iDoes he think that none sees him?} Mujahid said, "Does he think that Allah, the Mighty and Majestic, does not see him." Others among the Salaf have said similar to this. Allah said; 4 /J J-i \$} iHave We not made for him two eyes?} meaning, for him to see with them. 4And a tongue meaning, for him to speak with, and so that he can express that which is inside of him. iand two lips?} In order to help him with speaking, eating food, and beautifying his face and his mouth. The Ability to distinguish between Good and Evil is also a Blessing 4.And shown him the two ways?} This refers to the two paths. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from 'Asim, from Zirr, from 'Abdul- lah bin Mas*ud that he said, iwJl \$And shown him the two ways?} "The good and the evil."12' Similar to this has been reported from 'Ali, Ibn 'Abbas, Mujahid, Ikiimah, Abu Wa'il, Abu Salih, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Ad- Dahhak, and 'Ata' Al-Khurasani among others.131 Similar to this Ayah is Allah's statement, m At-Tabari 24:436. 121 At-Tabari 24:437. 131 At-Tabari 24 :437 , 438 , and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8 :52 1 , 522

486 Tafsir Ibn Kathir J tXliSJts£S > -->v o\i mm jSfi '{r< la^oli^cifiSLi^ca s^<Sk^;«aGQ*£^i'0 Od2KibS;te5\$£iJi^iKOi^i .-"^if.//A."" . •'-.»' 13L_JuQp4_i— Jy_)>t^juJUnJj I 5^}£~>JviW \$>>61^1\$

S^5\$^b^\$^!PSiyav -_-"- idu»j j_li gLiji til dj "ijCs^i iVerily, We have created man from Nutfah Amshdj, in order to try him : so We made him hearer and seer. Verily, We showed him the way, whether he be grateful or ungrateful .} (76:2-3) ik\$ Cj ipz& pa *» ;1 i& ^tLJf u £rjt &} {S. j 2*4 li 'CSf^i jl li ip: <\$ OJ sf ii P® £4PS »s • '.' *. >/ -1 *> tV,l M??- But he has not attempted to pass on the path that is steep.} 422. And what will make you know the path that is steep?} 423. Freeing a neck 424. Or giving food in a dayfidl of Masghabah,} 415. To an orphan near of kin.} 416 . Or to a Miskin cleaving to dust.} 417. Then he became one of those who believed and recommended one another to patience, and recommended one another to compassion.}

487 Surah 90. Al-Balad (11-20) (Part-30) 418. They are those on the Right,) 419. But those who disbelieved in Our Ayat, they are those on the Left.) 420. Upon them Fire toill Mu'sadah.) The Encouragement to traverse upon the Path of Goodness Ibn Zayd said, 4But he has not attempted to pass on the path that is steep.) "This means, will he not traverse upon the path which contains salvation and good? Then He explains this path by his saying, 4Z£l jl % (pXSf C Zj) 4And what will make you know the path that is steep? Freeing a neck, or giving food.)" ^ Imam Ahmad recorded from Said bin Maijanah that he heard Abu Hurayrah saying that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jZi I j* Zj\ - j Jtl - ijil fri-\ 03 3r*" J\ t3lJl JuJU <11 «Whoever frees a believing slave, Allah will free for every limb (of the slave) one of his limbs from the Fire. This is to such an extent that He (Allah) will free a hand for a hand, a leg for a leg, and a private part for a private part.» 'Ali bin Al-Husayn then said (to Said), "Did you hear this from Abu Hurayrah?" Said replied, "Yes." Then 'Ali bin Al-Husayn said to a slave boy that he owned who was the swiftest of his servants, "Call Mutarrif!" So when the slave was brought before him he said, "Go, for you are free for the Face of Allah. Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, all recorded this Hadith from Said bin Maijanah J31 At-Tabari 24:440. 121 Ahmad 2 :422 131 Path Al-Bdri 5:174 and 11:608, and Muslim 2:1147, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :144 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 3 :168

Ahmad recorded this Hadith from different routes of transmission that are good and strong, and all praise is due to Allah. Allah said, ^& a %£i& 4Or giving food in a day fidl of Masghabah,} Ibn 'Abbas said, "Of hunger." 'Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others all said the same. 121 The word 'Saghb' means hunger. Then Allah says, 4^0 4To an orphan> meaning, he gives food on a day like this to an orphan. v>r inear of kin. meaning, who is related to him. Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi all said this.' 3 This is similar to what was related in a Ifadith that was collected by Imam Ahmad on the authority of Salman bin 'Amir who said that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say, ^Charity given to the poor person is counted as one charity, while if it is given to a relative it is counted as two : charity and connecting the ties (of kinship) .» At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal 151 both recorded this Hadith and its chain of narration is authentic. Then Allah says, iOr to a Misdln cleaving to dust (Dim Matrabah meaning, poor, miserable, and clinging to the dirt. It means those who are in a state of destitution. Ibn 'Abbas said, uDha Matrabah is that who At-Tabari 24:442. At-Tabari 24:442, 443. 131 Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 8 :525 Ahmad 4 :214. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 3 :324, and An-Nasal 5 :92

491 Surah 90. Al-Balad (11-20) (Part-30) «Allah will not be merciful with whoever is not merciful with the people» Abu Dawud recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr that he narrated (from the Prophet jg), «Whoever does not show mercy to our children, nor does he recognize the right of our elders, then he is not o/ws.» Then Allah says, iThey are those on the Right, meaning, those who have these characteristics

are the companions of the Right Hand. The Companions of the Left Hand and Their Recompense Then Allah says, iBut those who disbelieved in Our Ayat, they are those on the Left> meaning, the companions of the Left Hand. iUpon them Fire will Mu'sadah.} meaning, it will be sealed over them and there will be no way for them to avoid it, nor will they have any way out. Abu Hurayrah, Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, 'Atiyah Al-'Awfi, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi, all said, 4Mu'sadah.\$ “This means shut.”*31 Ibn 'Abbas said, “Its doors will be closed.”*41 Ad-Dahhak said. Muslim 4 :1809. *21 Abu Dawud 5 :231 At-Tabari 24 :447 , and Ad-DunAl-Manthur8 :526 *41 Ad-DunAl-Manthur 8 :526

Surah 90: Al-Balad

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6438–6439]

Opening iMu'sadah.} “It will be sealed over them and it will have no door.” Qatadah said, \$Mu'sadah.\$ “It will be shut and there will be no light in it, no crevice (escape), and no way out of it forever.”

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6439–6447]

Recitation of Surah Ash-Shams wa Duhaha in the ‘Isha’ Prayer The Hadith of Jabir which was recorded in the Two Sahihis has already been mentioned. In it the Messenger of Allah jg said to Mu'adh, k P>& ip? Why didn't you pray with (the recitation of) 4Glorify the Name of your Lord the Most Highfr (87), 4By the sun and Duhaha^ (91), and 4By the night as it envelops?fr (92)» ^0P *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 4'V->W— i>* v'*- •&) . SfP'j 41. By the sun and Duhaha. 42. By the moon as it Talaha .fr 43. By the day as it Jallaha 44. By the night as it Yaghshaha 45. By the heaven andMa Bahdha 46. By the earth and Ma Tahhdha.fr 47. By Nafs, andMa Sawwdhd (Who apportioned it).fr hi Fath Al-Bari 2 :234, and Muslim 1 :340.

48. Then He showed it its Fujur and its Taqwa 49. Indeed he succeeds who purifies it.} 410. And indeed Ik fails who Dassaha.} Allah swears by His Creation that the Person Who purifies Himself will be Successful and the PersonWho corrupts Himselfwill fail Mujahid said, 4By the sun and Duhaha “This means, by its light.” ’ Qatadah said, 4wa Duhaha.} “The whole day.”*2 * Ibn Jarir said, “The correct view is what has been said, ‘Allah swears by the sun and its daytime, because the clear light ofthe sun is daytime.’ ” *p5» 4By the moon as it Talaha.} Mujahid said, “It follows it (the sun).”*3 ’ Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas that he said, VP'^ 4By the moon as it Talaha.} “It follows the day.”*4 ’ Qatadah said, “ as it Talaha (follows it)’ is referring to the night of the Hilal (the new crescent moon). When the sun goes down, the Hilal is visible.”*5 ’ Concerning Allah’s statement, 4By the day as it Jallaha.} Mujahid said, “When it illuminates.”*6’ Thus, Mujahid said, At-Tabari 24:451. At-Tabari 24:451. At-Tabari 24 :452 4| At-Tabari 24:452. At-Tabari 24:452. ’6| At-Tabari 24:529.

iBy the day as it Jallahd.> “This is similar to Allah’s statement, u hm iBy the day as it Tajalld.} (92:2)” And they have said concerning Allah’s statement, iBy the night as it Yaghshdhd.} meaning, when it covers the sun, which takes place when sun disappears and the horizons become dark. Concerning Allah’s statement, iBy the heaven and Ma Banahd.} The meaning here could be for descriptive purposes, meaning “By the heaven and its construc- tion.” This was said by Qatadah. It could also mean “By the heaven and its Constructor.” This was stated by Mujahid.111 Both views are interrelated, and

construction means raising. This is as Allah says, {With Hands did We construct the heaven.} (51:47) meaning, with strength. {Verily, We are able to extend the vastness of space thereof. And We have spread out the earth : how excellent a spreader are We!} (51:47-48) This is also similar to Allah's statement, {By the earth and Ma Tahaha.} Mujahid said, "Tahaha means He spread it out."*21 Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, ««#G> iandMa Tahaha.} "This means what He created in it."*3 'Ali bin At-Tabari 24:453. 121 At-Tabari 24:454. [31 At-Tabari 24:453.

them and distracted them from their religion Then Allah says, {Then He showed it its Ftijir and its Taqwa.} meaning, He showed him to his transgression and his Taqwa. This means that He clarified that for it and He guided it to what has been ordained for him. Ibn 'Abbas said, {Then He showed it its Fujur and its Taqwa.} "He explained the good and the evil to it (the soul)."*2 Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and Ath-Thawri all said the same.*3 * Said bin Jubayr said, "He gave him inspiration (to see what was) good and evil." Ibn Zayd said, "He made its Fujur and its Taqwa inside of it." Ibn Jarir recorded from Abul-Aswad Ad-Dlli that he said, "Imran bin Husayn said to me, 'Do you think that what the people do, and what they strive for is a thing that is pre- ordained and predestined for them, or is it a thing which is only written after the Message comes to them from the Prophet 3g, when there will be an evidence against them?' I said, 'Rather it is something preordained upon them.' Then he said, Is that an injustice?' Then I became extremely frightened of him (due to what he was saying), and I said to him, There is nothing except that He (Allah) created it and possesses it in His Hand. He is not asked about what He does, while they (His creation) will be asked.' He (Imran) then said, 'May Allah guide you! I only asked you about that in order to inform you that a man from Muzaynah or Juhaynah tribe came to the Allah's Messenger ^5 and asked him: "O Messenger of Allah! Do you consider the actions of mankind and their struggles to be preordained for them and written for them from Qadr, or something written for them 111 Muslim 4:2197. 121 At-Tabari 24 :454 (3 > At-Tabari 24:455. Af-Tabari 24:455.

This is like what was reported by Al-'Awfi and 'Ali bin Abi Talhah from Ibn 'Abbas. At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "The Messenger of Allah jg used to stop whenever he recited this Ayah, J ./// tJ'i, 4By Nafs, and Ma Saxvwdhd (Who apportioned it). Then He showed it its Fujur and its Taqwa.} Then he would say, c \k\yu «0 Allah! Give my sold its good. You are its Guardian and Master, and the best to purify it.» 2' Another Hadith Imam Ahmad recorded that Zayd bin Arqam said that the Messenger of Allah said, ^ \k r*^' .[Z'jy lUilj if* 'frt- oji itfjj iUi^s ol V ly-Yj j*j *^~**d 'i l/i i>! oO Allah! Verily, I seek refuge with You from weakness, laziness, senility (of old age), cowardliness, stinginess and the torment of the grave. O Allah! Give my sold its good and purify it, for You are the best to purify it. You are its Guardian and Master. O Allah! Verily, I seek refitge with You from a heart that is not humble, a soul that is not satisfied, knowledge that does not benefit and a supplication that is not answered.» Zayd then said, "The Messenger of Allah sg used to teach us these (words) and we now teach them to you."*3 * Muslim also recorded this Hadith. 111 At-Tabari 24:457. * At-Tabarani 11 : 106. *31 Ahmad 4 :371. * Muslim 4:2088

m o\o g&m- mm"V JUJ C*»Jl ^^S?O*is^4&3j0i&;j3 a LgjjjJaJ x .•<, s ><". >><!r< li'.U' f-l^-l- a t aj jA m<i ojJJijo Ujy *(j . ** ,=>&>."/?> -t * f< >-*- » <-' a:M n £2&\$Qa£\$3&&®«2»££5 . «SSip /* I-' A A- •" !l ^ *>. J& jui fSji+uil 'f^i^Llj it iit it s* .s s. >>'.? , (U_*J_*» L->»jjijj »^j6o j& ;# 4^^ •*£\$ 111. Thamud denied through their trans- gression.\$> 112. When their most wicked wentforth.} 113. But the

Messenger of Allah said to them : “Be cautious! That is the she- camel of Allah! (Do not harm it) and (bar it not from having) its drink!”} 114. Then they denied him and they killed it. So their Lord destroyed them because of their sin, Fasaxmvahd!} i!5. And Hefeared not the consequences thereof.} The Rejection of Thamud and Allah’s Destruction of Them Allah informs that Thamxld rejected their Messenger because of the injustice and transgression they practiced. This was said by Mujahid, Qatadah and others . 111 Therefore, this resulted in a rejection in their hearts for the guidance and conviction their Messenger came to them with. «i-4t iWhen their most wicked wentforth.} [il At-Tabari 24 :458 .

meaning, the most wicked person of the tribe, and he was Qudar bin Salif, the one who killed the she-camel. He was leader of the tribe of Thamud, and he is the one whom Allah refers to in His saying, iBut they called their comrade and he took (a sword) and killed (her).} (54:29) This man was mighty and respected among his people. He was of noble lineage and a leader who was obeyed. This is just as Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘Abdullah bin Zam'ah. He said that the Messenger of Allah jfe gave a sermon in which he mentioned the she-camel and he mentioned the man who killed her. Then he said, i^When their most wicked went forth.} A strong and mighty man who was invincible among his tribe, like Abu Zam'ah, wentforth to her.» il] This Hadith was recorded by Al-Bukhari in his Book of Tafsir, and Muslim in his Book of the Description of the Hellfire. At- Tirmidhi and An-Nasal both recorded it in their Sunans in their Books of Tafsir^ The Story ofSalih’s She-Camel Allah then says, iBut the Messenger ofAllah said to them referring to Salih. iThat is the she-camel ofAllah!} meaning, “beware of touching the she-camel ofAllah with any harm.’ 111 Ahmad 4:17. * Path Al-Bari 8 :575 , Muslim 4 : 2191 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :268 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :515

Surah 91: Ash-Shams

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6448–6449]

Opening 502 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4and its drink!} meaning, ‘do not transgress against her in her drinking, for she has been allocated a day to drink and you have been allocated a day to drink, as is known to you.’ Then Allah says, 4Then they denied him and they killed it.} which means they rejected what he came with. This resulted in them killing the she-camel that Allah had brought out of the rock as a sign for them and a proof against them. 4So their Lord destroyed them because of their sin,} meaning, He became angry with them and He annihilated them. iFasa iowaha!} meaning, He made the punishment descend upon them all equally. Qatadah said, “It has reached us that the leader of tribe of ThamQd did not kill the she-camel until their youth, their elderly, their males and their females all pledged allegiance to him. So when the people cooperated in killing her, Allah destroyed them all with the same punishment due to their sin.” * Allah said, \$} 4And He feared not} it has also been recited as (So He feared not) 4the consequences thereof.} Ibn ‘Abbas said, “Allah does not fear any consequences from anyone else.”¹²¹ Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Bakr bin ‘Abdullah Al-Muzani and others all said the same.*³

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6449–6460]

The Recitation of Surat Al-Layl in the ‘Isha’ Prayer The statement of the Prophet to Mu’adh has already preceded, where he said, i’h iJSflK ?rh aWhy did you not pray with (the recitation of) iGlorify the Name of your Lord the Most High^ (87), and iBy the sun and Duhahd} (91), and iBy the night as it envelops?} (92)» (11 In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Z ft k && C ^ & £ a? Odfc d -’•SiJ. V’ 11 . By the night as it envelops. 12. By the day as it appears.} 43. By Him Who created male and female.} 14. Certainly, your efforts and deeds are diverse.} 15. As for him who gives and has Taqwa,} 16. And believes in Al-Husna.} We will make smooth for him the path of ease.} 18. But he who is greedy and thinks himself self-sufficient,} 19. And denies Al-Husna.} i!O. We will make smooth for him the path to evil.} I1 * Fath Al-Bari 2 :234 , and Muslim 1 :340

504 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ill. And what will his wealth avail him when he goes down (in destruction)?) Swearing by the Diversity of Mankind in Their Efforts and informing of the Different Results of that Allah swears by saying: -4’ iBy the night as it envelops. meaning, when it covers the creation with its darkness. iBy the day as it appears.) meaning, with its light and its radiance. 3L c,) iBy Him Who created male and female.) This is similar to Allah’s saying, iAnd We have created you in pairs.) (78:8) It

is also similar to His saying, (And of everything We have created pairs.) (51:49) And just as these things that are being sworn by are opposites, likewise that which this swearing is about are opposing things. This is why Allah says, (Certainly, your efforts and deeds are diverse.) meaning, the actions of the servants that they have performed are also opposites and diverse. Therefore, there are those who do good and there are those who do evil. Allah then says, (As for him who gives and has Taqwd.) meaning, he gives what he has been commanded to give and he fears Allah in his affairs.

And believes in Al-Husna.) meaning, in the compensation for that. This was said by Qatadah. Khusayf said, "In the reward." Then Allah says. (We will make smooth for him the path of ease.) Ibn 'Abbas said, "Meaning for goodness." Thus, Allah says, (But he who is greedy) meaning, with that which he has. And thinks himself self-sufficient,) 'Ikrimah reported that Ibn 'Abbas said, "This means he is stingy with his wealth and considers himself to be in no need of his Lord, the Mighty and Majestic." This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. (And denies Al-Husna.) meaning, the recompense in the abode of the Hereafter. (We will make smooth for him the path to evil.) meaning, the path of evil. This is as Allah says, (And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away, as they refused to believe therein for the first time, and We shall leave them in their trespass to wander blindly.) (6:110) And there are many Ayat with this meaning, proving that Allah rewards those who intend good with success, while At-Tabari 24:470. 'Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8:535, (3) At-Tabari 24:472.

whoever intends evil is abandoned, and all of this is in accordance with a preordained decree. There are also many Hadiths that prove this. The Narration of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Bakr that he said to the Messenger of Allah, "O Messenger of Allah! Do we act according to what has already been decided, or is the matter just beginning (i.e., still undecided)?" He replied, (Indeed it is according to what has already been decided). Then Abu Bakr said, "Then what (good) are deeds, O Messenger of Allah?" He replied, «Everyone will find it easy to do such deeds that will lead him to what he was created for.» [1 The Narration of 'Ali Al-Bukhari recorded from 'Ali bin Abi Talib that they (the Companions) were with the Messenger of Allah at the cemetery of Baqi' Al-Gharqad for a funeral, when the Prophet said. «[1] sJLaJl*j a-bLil JJj V1 JI>- 1 {jA U> *Thcre is none among you except that his place has already been written, a seat in Paradise and a seat in the Hellfire.v They said, "O Messenger of Allah! Should we depend on this?" He replied, U j~a oPerform deeds for everyone will have the deeds of what he was created for (Paradise or Hell) made easy for him.* Then he recited the Ayah m Ahm id 1:5. Similar with Muslim, no. 17 in the Book of Faith

507 Surah 92. Al-Layl (1-11) (Part-30) (4) As for him who gives and has Taqwd, and believes in Al-Husna. We will make smooth for him the path of ease.y^ until the Ayah (the path to evil) He (Imam Al-Bukhari) also recorded another similar narration from 'Ali bin Abi Talib in which he said, "We were at a funeral in the cemetery of Baqi' Al-Gharqad when the Messenger of Allah jg came and sat down. So we came and sat around him and he had a stick with him. Then he bowed his head and he began to scratch the ground with his stick. He then said, tjUl j iliJl ja VI ^ > • f J y | ^ j | ^ z ® j I Jj 'There is not anyone among you - or is not a single soul (that has been created) - except that his place has been written in Paradise or in the Fire, and it has been written that he will be miserable or happy. A man said, "O Messenger of Allah! Should we just depend on what has been written for us and give up performing

deeds? For whoever of us is of the people of happiness then he will be of the people of happiness, and whoever among us is of the people of misery then he will be of the people of misery.” The Prophet jgs replied, J\ \ tul)l Jif Ulj U ioU—J1 J Si p Jif \fS “Those people who are the people of happiness, they will have the deeds of the people of happiness made easy for them . And those people who are the people of misery, they will have the deeds of the people of misery made easy for them.* Then he recited the Ayah: ,M Fath Al-Bari 8 :578 , 579

4As for him who gives and has Taqwd, and believes in Al- Hnsna. We will make smooth for him the path of ease (goodness). But he wlv is greedy and thinks himself self- sufficient, and belies Al-Husna. We will make smooth for him the path to The other compilers of the Group have also recorded this HadithPI The Narration of ‘Abdullah bin ‘Umar Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn Umar that Umar said, “O Messenger of Allah! Do you think that the deeds that we do are a matter that is already predetermined or are they something just beginning or new?” The Prophet replied, • it * ' tt-jUaiJl y\ IJ lil; £ji ji U-j# laj iSjU.UI 'Oli Sj lll «/f is something that has already been predetermined. Therefore, work deeds, O son of Al-Khattab! For verily, each person will have things made easyfor him . So whoever isfrom the people of happiness, then he will work deeds for happiness, and whoever is from the people of misery, then he will work deeds for misery,n”131 This Hadxth has been recorded by At-Tirmidhi in the Book of Al-Qadar and he said “Hasan Sahih.”!4, AnotherHadith Narrated by Jabir Ibn Jarir recorded from Jabir bin ‘Abdullah that he said, “O Messenger of Allah! Are we performing deeds for something that has already been predetermined or is the matter based upon what we are just doing (now)?” The Prophet replied, «AU -U 111 FathAl-B&ri 8:579. Muslim no. 2039, 2040, Abu Dawud 5:68, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6:340, and 9:270, An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6:516, 517, and Ibn Mtjah 1 :30 [31 Ahmad 2 :52 I4 * Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi6 :933

509Surah 92. Al-Laul (12-21) (Part-30 ‘It is a matter that has been predetermined .» Then Suraqah said, “Then what is the purpose of deeds?” The Messenger of Allah jg then said, 'jsi •Everyone who does deeds will have his deeds made easy for /imi.#' Muslim also recorded this Hadith . [2] Ibn Jarir recorded from ‘Amir bin ‘Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr that he said, “Abu Bakr used to free servants upon their acceptance of Islam in Makkah. He used to free the elderly and the women when they accepted Islam. So his father said to him, ‘O my son! I see that you are freeing people who are weak. But if you freed strong men they could stand with you, defend you and protect you.’ Abu Bakr replied, ‘O my father! I only want - and I think he said - what is with Allah.’ Some people of my family have told me this Ayah was revealed about him: }As for him who gives and has Taqwa, and believes in Al- Husna. We will make smoothfor him the path ofease.y*3 Then Allah says, iAnd what will his wealth avail him when he goes down?} Mujahid said, “This means when he dies.”^ Abu Salih and Malik said - narrating from Zayd bin Aslam, “When he goes down into the Fire.”151 \$JSf 4i -i t\$:jz <jt '<& u% * iMA \$ % 4S 4^ &4 «Pi H>a %•> 'h A 111 At-Tabari 24:475. 121 MusUm 4:2041. I3 * At-Tabari 24 :473 . There are some deficiencies in these narrations ,41 At-Tabari 24:476. ,S1 At-Tabari 24 :476 , and Al-Qurtubi 20 : 85

510 TafsJr Ibn KathTr 412. Truly, on Us is (to give) guidance . 413. And trtdy, unto Us (belong) the last (Hereafter) and the first (this world). 414. Therefore I have warned you ofa Fire Talazza .} 415. None shall enter it save the most wretched. 416. Who denies and turns away.} 417. And those with Taqwd

will be far removed from it.} 418. He who gives of his wealth for self-purification.} . 413- And who has (in mind) no favor from anyone to be paid back.} 420. Except to seek the Face of his Lord, the Most High.} 421. He, surely, will be pleased.} The Matter of Guidance and other than it is in the Hand of Allah, and Allah's Warning about the Hellfire Qatadah said, 4Truly, on Us is (to give) guidance.} "This means, We will explain what is lawful and what is prohibited." ' Others have said that it means, "Whoever traverses upon the path of guidance, then he will reach Allah (i.e., in the Hereafter)." They consider this Ayah like Allah's saying, 4^0 4And upon Allah is the responsibility to explain the Straight path.} (16:9) This has been mentioned by Ibn Jarir.12 Allah said; 4^% \j f& u £ } 4And truly, unto Us (belong) the last (Hereafter) and the first (this world).} At-Jabari 24:477. At-Tabari 24:477.

521 Surah 92. Al-Laul (12-21) (Part-30 This means, "they both belong to Us and I (Allah) am in complete control of them." Then Allah says, 4Therefore I have warned you of a Fire Talazza.£ Mujahid said, "Blazing."111 Imam Ahmad recorded from Simak bin Harb that he heard An-Nu'man bin Bashir giving a sermon, in which he said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah giving a sermon, in which he said: «/ have warned you of the Fire .« And he said it in such a voice that if a man was in the marketplace he could hear it from where I am standing now. And he said it (with such force) that the garment that was on his shoulder fell down to his feet."121 Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Ishaq that he heard An-Nu'man bin Bashir giving a sermon, in which he said, "I heard the Messenger of Allah saying, « Verily , the person to be punished lightest of the people of the Fire on the Day of Judgement will be a man who will have placed on the soles of his feet two coals that will cause his brain to boil/.»" 131 Imam Al-Bukhari also recorded this narration.141 Muslim recorded that Abu Ishaq narrated from An-Nu'man bin Bashir that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, JiAJ jli ^jA aJ jA IIIOP jlll » L Lil-ifi, Ala \a 1 l\ ® Verily , the lightest punishment received by the people of the At-Jabari 24 :477 121 Ahmad 4:272. 131 Ahmad 4 :274 141 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :424

Hellfire will be a man who will have two sandals whose straps will be made of fire that will cause his brain to boil just as a cauldron boils. Yet he will not think that anyone is receiving a torment more severe than him, even though he will be receiving the lightest punishment of them »• 1 Allah says, Vi V} iNone shall enter it save the most wretched.} meaning, none will enter surrounded by it on all sides except the most wretched. Then Allah explains who this (the most wretched) is by His saying, jjfi} iWho denies} meaning, in his heart. iand turns away.} meaning, from acting with his limbs and performing deeds according to their pillars. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah sg said, (ji kJ~*\ All of my followers will enter Paradise on the Day of Judgement except for whoever refusesJ They (the Companions) said, "Who would refuse, O Messenger of Allah?" He replied, ^Whoever obeys me, he will enter Paradise, and whoever disobeys me, then he has refused .»12* Al-Bukhari also recorded this HadithJ3 ' Allah then says, Muslim 1 :196 121 Ahmad 2:361. Fath Al-Bari 13:263.

513 Surah 92. Al-Laul (12-21) (Part-30) 4And those with Taqwa will be far removed from it.\$ meaning, the righteous, pure, most pious person will be saved from the Fire. Then He explains who he is by His saying, 4He who gives of his wealth for self-purification> meaning, he spends his wealth in obedience of his Lord in order to purify himself, his wealth and whatever Allah has bestowed upon him of religion and worldly things. 4A .&jS- i-ju Uj^ 4And who has (in mind) no favor from anyone to be paid back

meaning, giving his wealth is not done so that he may gain some favor from someone wherein they return some good to him, and therefore he gives to get something in return. He only spends his wealth if, £, 4to seek the Face ofhis Lord, the Most High meaning, hoping to attain the blessing of seeing Him in the final abode in the Gardens of Paradise. Allah then says, 4He, surely, will be pleased> meaning, indeed those with these characteristics will be pleased. The Cause ofthis Revelationand the Virtue ofAbuRaw Many of the scholars of Tafsir have mentioned that these Ayat were revealed about Abu Bakr As-Siddlq. Some of them even mentioned that there is a consensus among the Qur'anic commentators concerning this. There is no doubt that he is included in the meaning of these Ayat, and that he is the most deserving of the Ummah to be described with these characteristics in general, for indeed, the wording of these Ayat is general. As in Allah's saying, >•* ot -}M Cj /it* 43? *f\$ 4And those with Taqwa will be far removed from it. He who

Surah 92: Al-Layl

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6461–6468

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6461–6462]

Opening 515 Surah 92. Al-Layl (12-21) (Part-30) «Yes, and I hope that you will be one of them

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6462–6463]

msiiig mm Clip C|3 £o£?J«l»p'^Qp WL !B <,4' -<. i -> < 0^jpu^cp 5S» In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Uciv* (i i ^Jfcid'j^ ^>/ , "•>. "" // ",{/ />'/ y •> *#b • !..<# 4y l o>pj . * . 0; *iU Jr pi I-Aylryi d)Jj .j3.1l«J iili-jj SjiJliS iLi jJj *££ iiJu^ 4'c 1^)^“ \$ iy 1 ^ i3 * jjQi £fc + ""i /,«/ #y. il. By theforenoon .} 42. By the night when it darkens .> 43 . Your Lord has neither forsaken you nor hates you.} 44. And indeed the Hereafter is better for you than the present.} 45. And verily, your Lord will give you so that you shall be well-pleased.} 46. Did He not find you an orphan and gave you a refuge?) 47. And He found you unaware and guided you?) 48. And He found you poor and made you rich?) 49. Therefore, treat not the orphan with oppression.) 410. And repulse not the one who asks.) 411 . And proclaim the grace of your Lord.)

The Reason for the Revelation of Surat Ad-Duha

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6463–6468]

Imam Ahmad recorded from Jundub that he said, “The Prophet jg became ill, so he did not stand for prayer for a night or two. Then a woman came and said, ‘O Muhammad! I think that your devil has finally left you.’ So Allah revealed, 403£& c 0£W) 4By theforenoon. By the night when it darkens. Your Lord has neither forsaken you nor hates you. V Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal, Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir, all recorded this Hadxth . (a| This Jundub (who narrated it) is Ibn ‘Abdullah Al-Bajali Al-‘Alaqi. In a narration from Al-Aswad bin Qays, he said that he heard Jundub say that Jibiil was slow in coming to the Messenger of Allah jg. So the idolaters said, “Muhammad’s Lord has abandoned him.” So Allah revealed, 403 c;Z c 4By the forenoon. By the night when it darkens. Your Lord has neither forsaken you nor hates you.)l3] 40fc 4\$ 4By theforenoon. By the night when it darkens.) Al-‘Awfi reported from Ibn ‘Abbas, “When the Qur’an was revealed to the Messenger of AMh sg, Jibril was delayed from coming to him for a number of days (on one occasion). I 1 * Ahmad 4:312. 121 Fath Al-Bari 3:11, and 8:580, 581, 619, and Muslim 3:1421, 1422, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :272 An-Nasdl in Al-Kubra 6:517, and At-Tabari 24 :485 , 486 131 At-Tabari 24:486.

519 Surah 93. Ad-Duha (1-11) (Part-30) The Hereafter is Better Than This First Life 4 And indeed the Hereafter is better for you than the present meaning, the abode of the Hereafter is better for you than this current abode. For this reason the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to be the most abstinent of the people concerning the worldly things, and he was the greatest of them in his disregard for worldly matters. This is well known by necessity from his biography. When the Prophet ﷺ was given the choice at the end of his life between remaining in this life forever and then going to Paradise, or moving on to the company of Allah, he chose that which is with Allah over this lowly world. Imam Ahmad recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Mas‘ud said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was lying down on a straw mat and it left marks on his side. Then when he woke up he began to rub his side. So I said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Will you allow us to spread something soft over this straw mat?’ He replied, fīp cjjī t*ji i iiijjJj jtaD «/ have nothing to do with this world. The parable of me and this world is like a rider who rests in the shade of a tree, then he passes on and leaves if At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah both recorded this Hadith by way of Al-Mas‘udi. At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih .’<2 ‘ The Numerous Bounties of the Hereafter are waiting for the Messenger of Allah ﷺ Then Allah says, 4 And verily, your Lord will give you so that you shall be well- pleased. meaning, in the final abode Allah will give him until He pleases him concerning his followers, and in that which He has prepared for him from His generosity. From this will be 111 Ahmad 1:391. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7 :48 , and Ibn Majah 2 :1376.

the River of Al-Kawthar, which will have domes of hollowed pearls on its banks, and the mud on its banks will be the strongest fragrance of musk, as will be mentioned. Imam Abu ‘Amr Al-Awzal recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was shown that which his Ummah would be blessed with after him, treasure upon treasure. So he was pleased with that. Then Allah revealed, 4 And verily, your Lord will give you so that you shall be well- pleased.’ So, Allah will give him in Paradise one million palaces, and each palace will contain whatever he wishes of wives and servants.” This was recorded by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim from his route of transmission. ‘ This chain of narration is authentic to Ibn ‘Abbas, and statements like this can only be said from that which is Tawqifi A Mention of some of Allah’s Favors upon the Messenger Enumerating His favors upon His Messenger, Muhammad ﷺ, Allah says; 4 jJU fi\} 4 Did He not find you an orphan and gave you a refuge?} This refers to the fact that his father died while his mother was still pregnant with him, and his mother, Aminah bint Wahb died when he was only six years old. After this he was under the guardianship of his grandfather, ‘Abdul-Muttalib, until he died when Muhammad was eight years old. Then his uncle, Abu Talib took responsibility for him and continued to protect him, assist him, elevate his status, honor him, and even restrain his people from harming him when he was forty years of age and Allah commissioned him with the prophethood. Even with this, Abu Talib continued to follow the religion of his people, worshipping idols. 111 At-Tabari 24:487. 121 Meaning information that the Prophet informed him of.

522 Surah 93. Ad-Duha (1-11) (Part-30 All of this took place by the divine decree of Allah and His decree is most excellent. Until Abu Talib died a short time before the Hijrah. After this (Abu Talib’s death) the foolish and ignorant people of the Quraysh began to attack him, so Allah chose for him to migrate away from them to the city of Al-Aws and Al-Khazraj among those who helped him (in Al-Madīnah). Allah caused his Sunnah to be spread in the most perfect and complete manner. Then, when he arrived at their city, they gave him shelter, supported him, defended him and fought before him (against the enemies of Islam) - may Allah be pleased with all of them. All of this was from Allah’s

protection for him, guarding over him and caring for him. Then Allah says, *And We found you unaware and guided you*. } This is similar to Allah's saying, *And thus We have sent to you a Ruh from Our command, you knew not what is the Book, nor what is Faith. But We have made it a light wherewith We guide whosoever of our servants We will...* } (42 :52) Allah says, *And We found you poor and made you rich?* } meaning, "you were poor having dependents, so Allah made you wealthy and independent of all others besides Him." Thus, Allah combined for him the two positions: the one who is poor and patient, and the one who is wealthy and thankful. In the Two SahOis it has been recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah sg said, «Wealth is not determined by abundance of possessions, but

522 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr wealth is the richness of the soul, s' 11 In Sahxh Muslim, it is recorded from 'Abdullah bin 'Amr that the Messenger of Allah jg said, «;ui ijci j UUS' j j j j ait oWhoever accepts Islam, is provided with his basic needs, and Allah makes him content with what He has given him, then he will be successful.^ How should this Bounty be responded to? Then Allah says, iTherefbre, treat not the orphan with oppression.} meaning, 'just as you were an orphan and Allah sheltered you, then do not oppress the orphan.' In other words, 'do not humiliate him, scorn him or despise him. Rather, you should be kind and gentle to him.' Qatadah said, "Be like a merciful father to the orphan. ",3' 4And repulse not the one who asks.} meaning, 'just as you were astray and Allah guided you, then do not scorn the one who asks for knowledge seeking to be guided.' Ibn Ishaq said, iAnd repulse not the one who asks.} "This means do not be oppressive, arrogant, wicked, or mean to the weak among Allah's servants." Qatadah said, "This means respond to the poor with mercy and gentleness."14' iAnd procalim the grace of your Lord.} Fath Al-Bari 11:276, and Muslim 2:726 with this chain of narration and another chain as well. Muslim 2:730. 131 Al-Qurtubi 20:100. '4 ' Al-Baghawi 4:500.

Surah 93: Ad-Duha

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6469–6472

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6469–6472]

Opening 523Siirah 93. Ad-Duha (Part-30) meaning, ‘just as you were poor and needy, and Allah made you wealthy, then tell about Allah's favor upon you.’ Abu Dawud recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg said, •>£ji i ‘j. 3>I £L; is oWhoever is not thankful to the people, then he is not thankful to At-Tirmidhi also recorded this Hadith and he said, "Sahih”J2 Abu Dawud recorded from Jabir that the Prophet jg said. jUi j t Jui s SSj ^Whoever overcomes some test (i.e., calamity) and mentions it (to others), then he is indeed thankful. And whoever conceals it, then indeed he was ungrateful Abu Dawud was alone in recording this Hadith.

Surah 94: Ash-Sharh

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6473–6476

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6473–6476]

Opening 527 Surah 94. Ash-Sharh (1-8) (Part-30) for your Lord.”

Surah 95: At-Tin

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6477–6477

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6477]

Opening 531 Surah 95. At-Tin (1-8) (Part-30) returned to decrepit old age.”¹¹¹ Ibn Jarir preferred this explanation.¹²¹ Even if this was the meaning, it would not be correct to exclude the believers from this, because some of them are also overcome by the senility of old age. Thus, the meaning here is what we have already mentioned (i.e., the first view), which is similar to Allah’s saying, iBy Al-'Asr. Verily man is in loss, except those who believe and perform righteous deeds.} (103:1-3) Concerning Allah’s statement. iThen they shall have a reward without end.} meaning, that will not end, as we have mentioned previously. Then Allah says, i&'JZ Q} iThen what causes you to deny} meaning, ‘O Son of Adam!’ iafter this the Recompense?} meaning, “in the recompense that will take place in the Hereafter. For indeed you know the beginning, and you know that He Who is able to begin (the creation) is also able to repeat it which is easier. So what is it that makes you deny the final return in the Hereafter after you have known this?’ Then Allah says, i^&&u iif £&\} ils not the Allah the best of judges?} meaning, ‘is He not the best of judges, Who does not oppress or do any injustice to anyone?’ And from His justice is that He will establish the Judgement, and He will give retribution to the person who was wronged in this life against whoever wronged him.

Surah 96: Al-Alaq

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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PDF pages: 6478–6486

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6478]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Iqra (Surat Al-‘Alaq) (Chapter - 96)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6478–6486]

This was the first of the Qur'an revealed in the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. V-ly I 4? . Read! In the Name of your Lord Who created. 42. He has created man from a clot.} 43. Read! And your Lord is the Most Generous. 44. Who has taught by the pen .} 45. He has taught man that which he knew not.} The Beginning of the Prophethood of Muhammadi and the First of the Qur'an revealed Imam Ahmad recorded that 'A'ishah said: The first thing that began happening with the Messenger of Allah jg from the revelation was dreams that he would see in his sleep that would come true. He would not see any dream except that it would come true just like the (clearness of) the daybreak in the morning. Then seclusion became beloved to him. So, he used to go to the cave of Hira' and devote himself to worship there for a number of nights, and he would bring provisions for that. Then he would return to Khadljah and replenish his provisions for a similar number of nights. This continued until the revelation suddenly came to him while he was in the cave of Hira'.

533 Surah 96. Al-'Alac (1-5) (Part-30 The angel came to him while he was in the cave and said, "Read!" The Messenger of Allah jg said, «/ replied: "I am not one who reads. Then he said, "So he (the angel) seized me and pressed me until I could no longer bear it. Then he released me and said: 'Read!' So I replied: "I am not one who reads.' So, he pressed me a second time until I could no longer bear it. Then he released me and said: 'Read!' So I replied: I am not one who reads.' So, he pressed me a third time until I could no longer bear it. Then he released me and said: iRead in the Name of your Lord who has created.} until he reached the Ayah, iThat which he knew not.}" So he returned with them (those At/dt) and with his heart trembling until he came (home) to Khadljah, and he said, «Wrap me up, wrap me up!» So they wrapped him up until his fear went away. After that Jr t)s BT MU rmm 'i.it -t MI tasn&s.

535 Surah 96. Al-'Alaq (1-5) (Part-30) settled and he would return (down from the mountain). Then, when the revelation did not come again for a long time, he set out as he had done before. So when he reached the peak of the mountain, Jibril appeared to him again and said to him the same as he had said before." This Hadlth has been recorded in the Two Sahihs by way of Az-Zuhri.*2 * We have already discussed this Hadith's chain of narration, its text and its meanings at length in the beginning of our

explanation of Sahih Al-Bukhari. Therefore, whoever would like to read it, it is researched there, and all praise and blessings are due to Allah. So the first thing that was revealed of the Qur'an were these noble and blessed Ayat. They are the first mercy that Allah bestowed upon His servants and the first bounty that Allah favored them with. The Honor and Nobility of Man is in His Knowledge These Ayat inform of the beginning of man's creation from a dangling clot, and that out of Allah's generosity He taught man that which he did not know. Thus, Allah exalted him and honored him by giving him knowledge, and it is the dignity that the Father of Humanity, Adam, was distinguished with over the angels. Knowledge sometimes is in the mind, sometimes on the tongue, and sometimes in writing with the fingers. Thus, it may be intellectual, spoken and written. And while the last (written) necessitates the first two (intellectual and spoken), the reverse is not true. For this reason Allah says, *Read!* And your Lord is the Most Generous. Who has taught by the pen. He has taught man that which he knew not.} There is a narration that states, "Record knowledge by writing." *3 * There is also a saying which states, "Whoever acts Ahmad 6:232. * Fath Al-Bari 12:368, and Muslim 1 :139. * This "narration" is an unauthentic Hadith. See Al-Hakim 1 :106. It is also attributed to a saying of Umar with a weak chain of narration with Ibn Abi Shaybah (26418) and others.

537 Surah 96. Al-'Alaa (6-19) (Part-30 Surely, unto your Lord is the return.) meaning, "unto Allah is the final destination and return, and He will hold you accountable for your wealth, as to where you obtained it from and how did you spend it." Scolding of Abu Jahl and the Threat of seizing Him Then Allah says, *Cu. ! Have you seen him who prevents. A servant when he prays?*} This was revealed about Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him. He threatened the Prophet for performing Salah at the Ka'bah. Thus, Allah firstly admonished him with that which was better by saying, *ji Have you seen if he is on the guidance.*} meaning, 'do you think this man whom you are preventing is upon the straight path in his action, or 'A& <£Or enjoins Taqwa?' in his statements? Yet, you rebuke him and threaten him due to his prayer.' Thus, Allah says, *S' % f. \$} iKtows he not that Allah sees?*} meaning, doesn't this person who is preventing this man who is following correct guidance know that Allah sees him and hears his words, and He will compensate him in full for what he has done? Then Allah says by way of warning and threatening, *•) j *} iNay! Ifhe ceases not,*} meaning, if he does not recant from his discord and obstinacy, *iWc zuill scorch his forehead.*} meaning, 'indeed We will make it extremely black on the Day of Judgement.' Then He says,

4A lying, sinful forehead!} meaning, the forehead of Abu Jahl is lying in its statements and sinful in its actions. 4>: \$\$} iThen let him call upon his council.} meaning, his people and his tribe. In other words, let him call them in order to seek help from them. 4We will call out the guards of Hell!} 'And they are the angels of torment. This is so that he may know who will win - Our group or his group?' Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Abu Jahl said, "If I see Muhammad praying at the Ka'bah, I will stomp on his neck.' So this reached the Prophet *sg*, who said, *ulfhe does, he will be seized by the angels*"} 1 ' 1 This Hadith was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal in their Books of Ta'sfir. 12* Likewise, it has been recorded by Ibn Jarir.*3 Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Jarir, all recorded it from Ibn 'Abbas with the following wording: "The Messenger of Allah was praying at the Maqam (prayer station of Ibrahim) when Abu Jahl bin Hisham passed by him and said, 'O Muhammad! Haven't I prevented you from this?' He threatened the Prophet *yg* and thus, the Messenger of Allah *yg* became angry with him and reprimanded him. Then he said, 'O Muhammad! What can you threaten me with? By Allah, 1

have the most kinsmen of this valley with me in the large.' Then Allah revealed, 4Then let him call upon his council. We will call out the guards of Hell!}” I 1 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :595 * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :277 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :518 131 At-Tabari 12:649.

539Surah 96. Al-'Alaq (6-19) (Part-30 Ibn 'Abbas then said, “If he had called his people, the angels of torment would have seized him at that very instant.” At- Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahth . Ibn Jarir recorded from Abu Hurayrah that Abu Jahl said, “Does Muhammad cover his face with dust (i.e., from prostration) while he is among you all?” They (the people) replied, “Yes.” Then he said, “By Al-Lat and Al-'Uzza, if I see him praying like this, I will stomp on his neck, and I will certainly put his face in the dust.” So the Messenger of Allah jg came and he began praying, which made it possible for Abu Jahl to stomp on his neck. Then the people became surprised at him (Abu Jahl) because he began retreating on his heels and covering himself with his hands. Then it was said to him, “What’s the matter with you?” He replied, “Verily, between me and him is a ditch of fire, monsters and wings.” Then the Messenger of Allah jg said. *If he had come near me, the angels would have snatched him limb by limb .» The narrator added; “Allah revealed an Ayah, but I do not know whether it is concerning the Hadith of Abu Hurayrah or not: iNay! Verily, man does transgress.} to the end of the Surah. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal, Muslim, An-Nasal and Ibn Abi Hatim all recorded this HadithP Amusement for the Prophet^ Then Allah says, y y?} iNay! Do not obey him.} meaning, ‘O Muhammad! Do not obey Ahmad 1 :329, At-Tirmidhi 3349, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 1 1684, and At-Tabari 12:648. At-Tabari 12:649. 131 Ahmad 2 : 370 , Mulim :2797 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 11683

Surah 97: Al-Qadr

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6487]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Qadr (Chapter - 97)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6487–6494]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, in the Night of Al-Qadr.} 42. And what will make you know what the Night of Al-Qadr is?} 43. The Night of Al-Qadr is better than a thousand months.} 44. Therein descend the angels and the Ruh by their Lord's permission with every matter.} 45. There is peace until the appearance of dawn.} The Virtues of the Night of Al-Qadr (the Decree) Allah informs that He sent the Qur'an down during the Night of Al-Qadr, and it is a blessed night about which Allah says, 4&P j 4We sent it down on a blessed night.} (44:3) This is the Night of Al-Qadr and it occurs during the month of Ramadan. This is as Allah says, 4The month of Ramadan in which was revealed the Qur'an.} (2:185) Ibn 'Abbas and others have said, "Allah sent the Qur'an down all at one time from the Preserved Tablet (Al-Lawh Al-Mahfud).

543 Surah 97. Al-Qadr (1-5) (Part-30) The Descent of the Angels and the Decree for Every Good during the Night of Al-Qadr Allah says, i i .py j* (pj ^ ^Therein descend the angels and the Ruh by their Lord's permission with every matter.} meaning, the angels descend in abundance during the Night of Al-Qadr due to its abundant blessings. The angels descend with the descending of blessings and mercy, just as they descend when the Qur'an is recited, they surround the circles of Dhikr (remembrance of Allah) and they lower their wings with true respect for the student of knowledge. In reference to Ar-Ruh, it is said that here it means the angel Jibril. Therefore, the wording of the Ayah is a method of adding the name of the distinct object (in this case Jibril) separate from the general group (in this case the angels). Concerning Allah's statement, ipf i with every matter.} Mujahid said, "Peace concerning every matter." Said bin Mansur said, Isa bin Yunus told us that Al-A'mash narrated to them that Mujahid said concerning Allah's statement, iJiX} iThere is peace} "It is security in which Shaytan cannot do any evil or any harm." Qatadah and others have said, "The matters are determined during it, and the times of death and provisions are measured out (i.e., decided) during it." Allah says, i. \: pP~Py yP. ^Therein is decreed every matter of decree.} (44:4) Then Allah says, tX &- X} }There is peace until the appearance of dawn.} Said bin Mansur said, "Hushaym narrated to us on the authority of Abu Ishaq, who narrated that Ash-Sha'bi said

concerning Allah's statement, {With every matter, there is a peace until the appearance of dawn.} The angels giving the greetings of peace during the Night of Al-Qadr to the people in the Masjids until the coming of Fajr (dawn).” Qatadah and Ibn Zayd both said concerning Allah's statement, {There is peace.} “This means all of it is good and there is no evil in it until the coming of Fajr (dawn).” Specifying the Night of Decree and its Signs This is supported by what Imam Ahmad recorded from Abdullah bin As-Samit that the Messenger of Allah said, لا *J jXKJ 41)1 j'j * l ^ if ^ jJlij! aJLJd j* cr-i - sj^ c/a ^j s 'o “The Night of Al-Qadr occurs during the last ten (nights). Whoever stands for them (in prayer) seeking their reivard, then indeed Allah will forgive his previous sins and his latter sins. It is an odd night: the ninth, or the seventh, or the fifth, or the third or the last night (of Ramadan)J The Messenger of Allah 36, also said, 'I ZLSL- i IjLs \jrj j's JjUj Ijil jjiJl <11) Sjlil jl ji jlj > 14-1 <1 'tj ijpm j 14«* ij j>u Nj (j-4J l4^rr-' “Verily, the sign of the Night of Al-Qadr is that it is pure and glowing as if there were a bright, tranquil, calm moon during it. It is not cold, nor is it hot, and no shooting star is permitted until morning . Its sign is that the sun appears on the morning following it smooth having no rays on it, just like the moon on a full moon night. Shaytan is not allowed to come out

with it (the sun) on that day .n 1 * 1 This chain of narration is good. In its text there is some oddities and in some of its wordings there are things that are objectionable. Abu Dawud mentioned a section in his Sunan that he titled, “Chapter: Clarification that the Night of Al-Qadr occurs during every Ramadan.” Then he recorded that ‘Abdullah bin Umar said, “The Messenger of Allah jg was asked about the Night of Al-Qadr while I was listening and he said, ajlij JSJ ilt occurs during every Ramadan .»”,2, The men of this chain of narration are all reliable, but Abu Dawud said that Shuhah and Sufyan both narrated it from Ishaq and they both considered it to be a statement of the Companion (Ibn ‘Umar, and thus not the statement of the Prophet s£). It has been reported that Abu Said Al-Khudri said, “The Messenger of Allah jg performed Vtikaf during the first ten nights of Ramadan and we performed Vtikaf with him. Then Jibril came to him and said. That which you are seeking is in front of you.’ So the Prophet % performed I'tikaf during the middle ten days of Ramadan and we also performed I'tikdf with him. Then Jibril came to him and said; That which you are seeking is ahead of you.’ So the Prophet jfe stood up and gave a sermon on the morning of the twentieth of Ramadan and he said, J,V) tjAijl & j cjlj^ gr-'fji JI J>\j f-l j\S <.)jJ yf-ljVl jliJl ^Whoever performed Vtikaf with me, let him come back (for Vtikaf again), for verily I saw the Night of Al-Qadr, and I was caused to forget it, and indeed it is during the last ten (nights). It is during an odd night and I saw myself as if I were prostrating in mud and waters The roof of the Masjid was made of dried palm-tree leaves and I 1 * Ahmad 5 :324. It is a Mursal narration. Abu Dawud 2:111. This narration is considered Mawquf.

we did not see anything (i.e., clouds) in the sky. But then a patch of wind-driven clouds came and it rained. So the Prophet jg lead us in prayer until we saw the traces of mud and water on the forehead of the Messenger of Allah gjg, which confirmed his dream.” In one narration it adds that this occurred on the morning of the twenty-first night (meaning the next morning). They both (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) recorded it in the Two SahiTis. Ash-Shafi‘i said, “This Hadith is the most authentic of what has been reported.” It has also been said that it is on the twenty-third night due to a Hadith narrated from ‘Abdullah bin Unays in Sahih Muslim , It has also been said that it is on the twenty-fifth night due to what Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn ‘Abbas that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ,j, ij. '1& ij. ja ^ “Seek it in the last ten (nights) of Ramadan. In the ninth it still remains, in the seventh it still remains, in the

fifth it still remains^{V31} Many have explained this Hadith to refer to the odd nights, and this is the most apparent and most popular explanation. It has also been said that it occurs on the twenty-seventh night because of what Muslim recorded in his Sahih from Ubay bin Ka*b that the Messenger of Allah mentioned that it was on the twenty-seventh night.⁴ Imam Ahmad recorded from Zirr that he asked Ubayy bin Ka*b, “O Abu Al-Mundhir! Verily, your brother Ibn Mas*ud says whoever stands for prayer (at night) the entire year, will catch the Night of Al-Qadr.” He (Ubayy) said, “May Allah have mercy upon him. Indeed he knows that it is during the month of Ramadan and that it is the twenty-seventh night.” Then he swore by Allah. Zirr then said, “How do you know that?” (I FathAl-Bari 4:329, 318, and Muslim 2:824. * Muslim 2:827. * FathAl-Bari 4:306. Muslim 2:828.

Ubayy replied, “By a sign or an indication that he (the Prophet jg) informed us of. It rises that next day having no rays on it - meaning the sun.”¹² Muslim has also recorded it.¹² It has been said that it is the night of the twenty-ninth. Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal recorded from TJbadah bin As-Samit that he asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the Night of Decree and he replied, ji j' ^4 j' <4~ ji 4-^ «Seek it in Ramadan in the last ten nights. For verily, it is during the odd nights, the twenty-first, or the twenty-third, or the twenty-fifth, or the twenty-seventh, or the twenty-ninth, or during the last night . [31 Imam Ahmad also recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said about the Night of Al-QacLr, ji J iUJi ill; %>Lii Uj ijijitj ji-l; j\ iZL. in «Verily , it is during the twenty-seventh or the twenty-ninth night. And verily, the angels who are on the earth during that night are more numerous than the number of pebbles.^ Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith and there is nothing wrong with its chain of narration. At-Tirmidhi recorded from Abu Qilabah that he said, “The Night of Al-Qadr moves around (i.e., from year to year) throughout the last ten nights.” This view that At-Tirmidhi mentions from Abu Qilabah has also been recorded by Malik, Ath-Thawri, Ahmad bin Hanbal, Ishfiq bin Rahuyah, Abu Thawr, Al-Muzani, Abu Bakr bin Khuzaymah and others. It has also been related from Ash-Shafil, and Al-Qadi reported it m Ahmad 5:130. I2 ' Muslim 2 :828 Ahmad 5:318. There is a deficiency in its chain of narration, but the meanings are found with others 141 Ahmad 2:519.

from him, and this is most likely. And Allah knows best. Supplication during the Night ofDecree It is recommended to supplicate often during all times, especially during the month of Ramadan, in the last ten nights, and during the odd nights of it even more so. It is recommended that one say the following supplication a lot: “O Allah! Verily, You are the Oft-Pardoning, You love to pardon, so pardon me.” This is due to what Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘A’ishah, that she said, “O Messenger of Allah! If I find the Night of Al- Qadrwhat should I say?” He replied, iSay: "O Allah! Verily, You are the Oft-Pardoning, You love to pardon, so pardon me."#111 At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah have all recorded this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Hasan Sahth.”¹²¹ Al- Hakim recorded it in his Mustadrak (with a different chain of narration) and he said that it is authentic according to the criteria of the two Shaykhs (Al-Bukhari and Muslim). ¹³¹ An- Nasal also recorded it .

Surah 98: Al-Bayyinah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6495–6501]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratLam Yakun (Al-Bayyinah)[] (Chapter - 98) Whichwas revealed inAl-Madmah The Messenger ofAllah jg recited this Surah to Ubayy Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas bin Malik that the Messenger of Allah jg said to Ubayy bin Kah, Jidp VfS ji 2)1 jj « Verily, Allah has commanded me to recite to you iThose who disbelievfrom among the People of the Scripture. Ubayy said, “He (Allah) mentioned me by name to you?” The Prophet jg replied, «Yes.» So he (Ubayy) cried .*21 Al-Bukhari, Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal all recorded this Hadlth from Shu'bah .*31 In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. * 3/5 jit i. \&0& t 4^11 tfj '4\ \$5 Cj &q ^{^2& if \j\$; y&f && '££ uat 2 a wei % vj % txfix 4'jj 41. Those who disbelieve from among the People of the Scripture and the idolators, were not going to leave until there came to them the Bayyinah . \$ 111 This Surah is also known as Al-Bayyinah. 121 Ahmad 3:130. *31 FathAl-Bari 8 :597, Muslim 1 :550, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 10:294, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :520

42. A Messengerfrom Allah, reciting purified pages. 43. Wherein are upright Books.} 44. And the People of the Scripture differed not until after there came to them the Bayyinah.} 45. And they were commanded not, but that they should worship Allah, making religion purely for Him alone, Hunafd', and that they perform Salah and give Zakdh, and that is the right religion .} Mentioning the Situation ofthe Disbelieversamongthe People ofthe Scripture and the Idolators As for the People of the Scripture, they are the Jews and the Christians, and the idolators are the worshippers of idols and fire among the Arabs and the non-Arabs. Mujahid said, they are not going 4to leave} “Meaning, they will not be finished until the truth becomes clear to them.” Qatadah also said the same thing.12 ' iuntil there came to them the Bayyinah.} meaning, this Qur'an. This is why Allah says, £Jj1; ,5.- c/M ££ ff} 4Those who disbelieve from among the People of the Scripture and idolators, were not going to leave until there came to them the Bayyinah.} Then He explains what the Bayyinah is by His saying, I*"" 'j£. Si Jf-j} 4A Messengerfrom Allah, reciting purified pages.} meaning, Muhammad and the Magnificent Qur'an he recites, which is written down among the most high gathering in purified pages. This is similar to Allah's statement. At-Tabari 24:539. 121 At-Tabari 24:539.

/X 'jsf 4^ 4hi Records held in honor. Exalted, purified, in the hands of scribes (angels). Honorable and obedient (80:13-16) Then Allah says, & £»> iWherein are upright Books. Ibn Jarir said, “Meaning in the purified pages are Books from Allah that are upright, just and straight. They have no mistakes in them because they are from Allah, the Mighty and Majestic. The Differing only occurred after the Knowledge came Allah says, 4' j viJJ' p&Z i* jkj [y 'i) jyj] 0\$ oy£ 4And the People of the Scripture differed not until after there came to them the Bayyinah .> This is similar to Allah's statement, i/z fi aijl;

hgt fz c z ^ bM W 4 '<ZZ iAnd be not as those who divided and differed among themselves after the Bayyindt came to them . It is theyfor whom there is an awful torment> (3:105) This refers to the people ofthose divinely revealed Scriptures that were sent down to the nations that were before us. After Allah established the proofs and evidences against them, they divided and differed concerning that which Allah had intended in their Scriptures, and they had many differences. This is like what has been reported in a Hadith that has many routes oftransmission, j N) jbil^ IxIiT i Cl JU !))> « Verily, the Jews differed until they became seventy-one sects. And verily, the Christians differed until they became seventy- m At-Tabari 24 :540.

552 Tafslr Ibn Kathir two sects. And this Ummah will divide into seventy-three sects, and all of them will be in the Fire except one.v They said, “Who are they, O Messenger of Allah?” He m replied, k3s. j(lit «(Those who are upon) what I and my Companions are upon .*111 TheCommandofAllahwasmerelythatTheymake their Religion solely forHim Allah says, 4&f J j Jit (jiGl 4And they were commanded not, but that they should worship Allah, making religion purelyfor Him alone,\$ This is similar to Allah’s statement, *0 vi\ v %4 3-i% j^j^ iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him : La ilaha ilia Atm.) (2 1 :25) Thus, Allah says, iHunafd’} meaning, avoiding Shirk and being truly devout to Tawhid. This is like Allah’s statement, 4And Verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): “Worship Allah, and avoid the Tdghut (false deities).”o (16:36) A discussion of the word Hardf has already been mentioned previously and in Surat Al-An’am, so there is no need to repeat it here.12 ’ ^ Al-Qurtubi 4 : 159 , 160. Similar with At-Tirmidhi. See volume three, the Tafslr of Surat Al-An’am (6:79), and volume four, the TafslrofSuratAl-A’r6f(7 :30)

553Surah 98. Al-Baxjyinah (6-8) (Part-30) J) -£2im otA "ifU" '*.H' *f lA' - -'..'n'. g 1 !S» 4«nd give Zakah,} This is doing good to the poor and the needy. o;j 4and that is the right religion. meaning, the upright and just reli- gion, or the nation that is straight and balanced. \$ it Ll^T >!+»• j i_4Clf ^ Jhljl ijli cyj£- tyii. iiJ#SJjii C?yt*' -rr^ ^ £-** (*rJ Xe. iy) 1 j^~ V [>l£} 4 ur*" i*i 4* i>^jj iili Ijil tj £SK w>i^ L/“ (*4lJj1 0 \pcj\ 4and perform Salah} And this is the best of the physical forms of worship. \Ci>\ ti:> 46 . Verily, those who disbelieve from among the People of the Scripture and idolators, will abide in the fire of Hell. They are the worst ofcreatures> 47. Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, they are the best ofcreatures.} 48. Their reward with their Lord is Eternal Gardens, underneath which rivers flow. They will abide therein forever, Allah will be pleased with them, and they well-pleased with Him. That is for him who fears his Lord.}

555Siirah 98. Al-Bayyinah (6-8) (Part-30) iarid they well-pleased with Him> Due to the comprehensive favors He has given them. Then Allah says, iThat is for him who fears his Lord.\$ meaning, this is the reward that will be attained by those who revere Allah and fear Him as He deserves to be feared. This is the person who worships Allah as if he sees Him, and he knows that even though he does not see Him, indeed Allah sees him. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jg said, pL j^J.1 N't iShall I not inform you of the best of creation ?> They said, “Of course, O Messenger of Allah!” He said, jLSy»-f Vf ^yL\ iila CjIS Uis i4)l JLsM „ •« * » • • r «ip' “A man who takes the reins of his horse in the way of Allah, and whenever there is a fearful cry from the enemy, he climbs upon it. Shall I not inform you of the best of creation ? They said, “Of course, O Messenger of Allah!” He said,

^ .oisp s^Lkii j* jii "A man who has a flock of sheep and he establishes the prayer and gives the obligatory charity. Shall I not inform you of the worst of creation? They said, "Of course." He said, j <ui> jL, •The person who is asked by Allah and he does not give by Him.

Surah 99: Az-Zalzalah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6502]

Opening 556 Tafsir Ibt Kathir The Tafsir of Surah Idha Zulzilat (Az-Zalzalah) (Chapter - 99)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6502–6510]

The Virtues of Surat Az-Zalzalah Imam Ahmad recorded from ‘Abdullah bin ‘Amr that he said, “A man came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and said. Teach me what to recite, O Messenger of Allah!’ The Prophet said, *olji jf IH {3I1D 1* Recite three from those [which begin] with the letters Alif, Lam, Rfl’o The man then said to him, *1* I have become old in age, my heart has hardened and my tongue has become harsh.’ The Prophet ﷺ said, ‘P*- hi “Then recite from those [which begin] with the letters Ha- Mim .« The man said the same thing as he had said before, so the Prophet ﷺ said, *^ i3*5 i;ii o* Recite three from the Miisiibbihaat .» The man again said the same thing as he had said before. Then the man said, “Rather give me something to recite that is comprehensive (of all of these), O Messenger of Allah.’ So the Prophet ﷺ told him to recite *iCputfj j>Vi 455 'H> 41* Mien the earth quakes with its Zilzal.} Then when he (the Prophet ﷺ) finished reciting the Surah to

him the man said, *By He Who has sent you with the truth as a Prophet, I will never add anything else to it.’ Then the man turned away and left, and the Prophet ﷺ said, *The little man has been successful, the little man has been successful .» Then the Prophet ﷺ said, «Aj •Bring him back to me. So the man came to him and the Prophet ﷺ said to him, ;J4J Ijlp 4)1 <Ii>- \ «/ have also been commanded to celebrate 'Id Al-Adha, which Allah has made a celebration for this Ummah .» The man said What do you think if I am only able to acquire a borrowed milking she-camel - should I slaughter it?’ The Prophet ﷺ said. •fcj^ <*>< ^4 •No. Bid you slwidd cut your hair, clip your nails, trim your mustache, shave your pubic area and that will be the completion of your sacrifice with Allah, the Mighty and Majestic,n”11 ' Abu Dawud and An-Nasal recorded this Hadith.™ sgn P In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. m % 0-v^ . l 1 ' Ahmad 2 :169. The majority consider this to be authentic. Al-Albfini said that the status of one of its narrators is not known . The rest of the scholars who commented on him consider him trustworthy. Abu Dawud 2:119, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 16 :5

41 . When the earth quakes with its Zilzal.} 42. And when the earth throws out its burdens.} 43 . And man will say : "What is the matter with it?"} 44. That Day it will declare its information.} 45. Because your Lord will inspire it.} 46. That Day mankind will proceed in scattered groups that they may be shown their deeds.} 47. So, whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.}

48. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.} The Day of Judgement, what will take place during it, the Condition of the Earth and the Condition of the People Ibn ‘Abbas said, 4When the earth quakes with its Zilzal.} “This means that it will move from beneath it.”¹¹¹ 4CP3&1 rr 4And when the earth throws out its burdens.} meaning, it will throw forth that which is in it of the dead. More than one of the Salaf have said this and it is similar to Allah’s statement. 4CP ‘O1 Vj Lj\$£} 40 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord! Verily, the earthquake (Zalzal) of the Hour is a terrible thing.} (22:1) This is also similar to His saying, 4And when the earth is stretched forth, and has cast out all Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :592

559 Surah 99. Az-Zalzal (1-8) (Part-30) that was in it and became empty. (84:3-4) Muslim recorded in his Sahih from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jg said, JjUJI tiJiiJlj JLf C «W* Iji 'J a^a "yj 4jj£-Jb i l-ift ^5 . ^3jl—Jl iThe earth will throw out the pieces of its liver (its contents). Gold and silver will come out like columns. A murderer will come and say, 7 killed for this?’ The one who broke the ties of kinship will say, ‘For this I severed the ties of kinship?’ The thief will say, ‘For this I got my hands amputated?’ Then they will leave it there and no one will take anything from it.” Then Allah says, iAnd man will say: “What is the matter with it?”} meaning, he will be baffled by its situation after it used to be stable, settled and firm, and he used to be settled upon its surface. This refers to the alteration of the state of things and the earth moving and shaking. There will come to it inescapable quaking that Allah prepared for it. Then it will throw out its dead people - from the first to the last generations. At that time the people will be baffled by the events and the earth changing into other than the earth, and the heavens as well. Then they will be presented before Allah, the One, the Irresistible. Concerning Allah’s statement, iThat Day it will declare its information.} meaning, it will speak of what the people did upon its surface. Imam Ahmad, At- Tirmidhi and Abu ‘Abdur-Rahman An-Nasal all recorded a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah - and in the wording of An-NasaTs version it states - that he said, “The Messenger of Allah jg recited this Ayah, 111 Muslim no. 1013.

iThat Day it will declare its information Then he said, La ijjjjh “Do you know what is its information?» They said, ‘Allah and His Messenger know best.’ He said, jf LL xfj xs. js jt^ij jt Ujllii oJi^j i 1-iSj OS’ \jSj \j£ « Verily, its information is that it will testify against every male and female servant, about what they did upon its surface. It will say that he did such and such on such and such day. So this is its information .»” Then At-Tirmidhi said, “This Hadith is Sahih Gharib.”¹ Concerning Allah’s statement, ol> iBecause your Lord will inspire it It is apparent that the implied meaning here is that He will permit it (the earth). Shablb bin Bishr narrated from ‘Ikrimah that Ibn ‘Abbas said, ^qpUjU-i iThat Day it will declare its information “Its Lord will say to it, ‘Speak.’ So it will speak.”^{12*} Mujahid commented (on “inspire it”), “ He commands it (i.e., to speak).”^{3 *} Al-Qurazi said, “He will command it to separate from them.” Then Allah says, i&£ if JiJi j iThat Day mankind will proceed in scattered groups (Ashtdtfy meaning, they will return from the station of the Judgement in *** Ahmad 2:374, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:285, and An-Nasal in Al- Kubra no. 1 1693. This Hadith rests upon a narrator whom many of the scholars consider unreliable. Al-Bukhari said, “Munkar,” Ibn Hajar said that he is “Feeble.” * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 8 :592 * At-Jabari 24:548.

separate groups. This means that they will be divided into types and categories: between those who are miserable and those who are happy, and those who are commanded to go to Paradise and those who are

commanded to go to the Hellfire. As-Suddi said, “Ashtat means sects.” 11 Allah said, 4that they may be shown their deeds.} meaning, so that they may act and be rewarded for what they did in this life of good and evil. The Recompense for Every Minute Deed Therefore, Allah goes on to say, l/—*)S> J—» ijjtJ-i irh SJ* J—^ iyty 4So whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of speck of dust shall see it.} Al-Bukhari recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jg said, \ ^JJI uti .jjj Js-'j f JeJ" jt ^ ^ \$ fry IJ jt ^^3 \ i>iwU)3J voLl> aJ ulS" j l ijJi ~ j jA Ifji fJ id Ijjlj Ubjlj il~l15 jZt ^3 j4-^' >4!^ idj otf o' if ' ^rr' 'Tj jil lildj III; *jjj^^^ *3io Jli00 'S «T7ie Worses are for three. For one man they are a reward, for another man they are a shield, and for another man they are a burden . In reference to the man for whom they are a reward, he is the man who keeps them to be used in the way of Allah Thus, they spend their entire life grazing in the pasture or garden (waiting in preparation for Jihad). So whatever afflicts them during that lengthy period in the pasture or garden, it 11 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur8:593.

water from your bucket to one who is seeking a drink, or meeting your brother with a cheerful faceV It is also recorded in the SahVi that the Prophet jg said, *0 party of believing women! None of you should belittle a gift sent by your neighbor, even if it is a Firsan of a sheep . |2' The word Firsan in this Hadith means its hoof. In another Hadith he said, aGive something to the beggar, even if it is a burnt hoofV It has been reported from 'A'ishah that she gave a single grape in charity and then she said, “To how much dust is it equivalent?”14 ' Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Awf bin Al-Harith bin At-Tufayl that 'A'ishah told him that the Prophet jg used to say, «U> <il^ LfJ jji aO 'A'ishah! Beware of the sins that are belittled, for indeed they will be taken account of by Allah . This Hadith was recorded by An-Nasal and Ibn Majah.'5 Imam Ahmad recorded from 'Abdullah bin Mas'ud that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^ “T 5'***!8 «Beware of the sins that are belittled. For verily, they are gathered in a man until they destroy him.n And indeed the Messenger of Allah jg made an example of them (sins that are taken lightly) by saying that they are like a people who settle in barren land. Then their leader comes and orders the men to go out one at a time and each bring back a I 1 * Muslim 4 :2026 Path Al-Bari 10:459. 131 Ahmad 5:381. 141 Al-Muwatta'2 :997 Ahmad 6:151 , and Ibn Mdjah no. 4243.

stick until they have gathered a large number of sticks. Then they kindled a fire and burned everything that they threw into it.

striving for the Hereafter, and He informs of what the situation will be after this present condition, and what man will face of horrors. He says, 4 c lij pZ&} AKnows he not that when the contents of the graves are poured forth?} meaning, the dead that are in it will be brought out. AAnd tltat which is in the breasts shall be made known?} Ibn ‘Abbas and others have said, “This means what was in their souls would be exposed and made apparent.” mh& k} AVerily, that Day their Lord will be Well-Acquainted with them.} meaning, He knows all of that they used to do, and He will m At-Tabari 24 :569

compensate them for it with the most deserving reward. He does not do even the slightest amount of injustice.

Surah 101: Al-Qariah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Qdri'ah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6516–6520]

(Chapter - 101) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. *Al-Qari'ah* is one of the names of the Day of Judgement, like *Al-Haqqah*, *At-Tammah*, *As-Sakhhah*, *Al-Ghashiyah* and other names. Then Allah intensifies concern and fright for it by saying, *And what will make you know what Al-Qari'ah is?*

Surah 101 . *Al-Qari'ah* (1-11) (Part-30) Then He explains this by saying, *It is a Day whereon mankind will be like moths scattered about.* meaning, in their scattering, their dividing, their coming and their going, all due to being bewildered at what is happening to them, they will be like scattered moths. This is like Allah's statement, *(If they were locusts spread abroad.)* (54:7) Allah said, *And the mountains will be like wool, carded.* meaning, they will become like carded wool that has begun to wear out (fade away) and be torn apart. Mujahid, 'Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi have all said, *like wool ('Ihn).* "Woolen." Then Allah informs about the results received by those who performed the deeds, and the honor and disgrace they will experience based upon their deeds. He says, *Then as for him whose Balance will be heavy.* meaning, his good deeds are more than his bad deeds. *He will live a pleasant life.* meaning, in Paradise. *But as for him whose Balance will be light.* meaning, his bad deeds are more than his good deeds. Then Allah says, *At-Jabari* 24:574.

Tafsir Ibn Kathir *His mother will be Hawiyah.* It has been said that this means he will be falling and tumbling headfirst into the fire of Hell, and the expression *'His mother'* has been used to refer to his brain (as it is the mother of his head). A statement similar to this has been reported from Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ikrimah, Abu Salih and Qatadah. Qatadah said, "He will fall into the Hellfire on his head."¹²¹ Abu Salih made a similar statement when he said, "They will fall into the Fire on their heads."¹³¹ It has also been said that it means his mother that he will return to and end up with in the Hereafter will be *Hawiyah*, which is one of the names of the Hellfire. Ibn Jarir said, "Al-Hawiyah is only called his mother because he will have no other abode except for it."¹⁴¹ Ibn Zayd said, "Al-Hawiyah is the Fire, and it will be his mother and his abode to which he will return, and where he will be settled." Then he recited the Ayah, *Their abode will be the Fire.* (3:151) ^{5!} Ibn Abi Hatim said that it has been narrated

from Qatadah that he said, "It is the Fire, and it is their abode." 161 Thus, Allah says in explaining the meaning of Al-Hawiyah, b %>j} iAnd what will make you know what it is?}. Allah's statement •Ux fc} ^A fire Hamiyah!} 111 At-Jabari 24:575, 576, and Al-Qurtubi 20:167. At-Tabari 24:576. 131 At-Tabari 24:575. At-Tabari 24:575. ,S1 At-Tabari 24:576. 161 At-Tabari 24:575.

meaning, extreme heat. It is a heat that is accompanied by a strong flame and fire. It is narrated from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet ﷺ said, 'r«- / *ojMy f3' «77ie fire of the Children of Adam that you all kindle is one part of the seventy parts of the fire of Hell . They (the Companions) said, "O Messenger of Allah! Isn't it sufficient?" He replied, «l: ,• > X » / yr JJLai D n/f is more than it by sixty-nine timesJ This has been recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim. of the wordings he stated, In some «/f is more than it by sixty-nine times, each of them is like the heat of itJ It has been narrated in a Hadth that Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet said, "apUo i J j* Clip j&\ jif jJa! jl« o Verily, the person who will receive the lightest torment of the people of the Hellfire will be a man who will have two sandals that will cause his brain to boil. »*2 It has been confirmed in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah said, 0: iU«; 4*3 ^ l#j J! j&l oS2«ll» U J-ilJ jlLlJl li JLi(i ^ *The Hellfire complained to its Lord and said, "O Lord! Some parts ofme devour other parts ofme." So He (Allah) permitted it to take two breaths : one breath in the winter and one breath in the summer. Thus, the most severe cold that you experience * Path Al-B&ri 6 :380, and Muslim 4 :2184. 121 Ahmad 2 :432 and 3:13.

in the winter isfrom its cold, and the most severe heat that you experience in the summer isfrom its heatJ ll] In the Two Sahths it is recorded that he said, ;Jui oli b3y% 'M «When the heat becomes intense pray the prayer when it cools down, for indeed the intense heat isfrom the breath ofHell

Surah 102: At-Takathur

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6521]

Opening The TafslrofSuratAt-Takathur (Chapter - 102)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6521–6527]

4S» In the Natne ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. *-*>“ ys j»j ..j, ij^o ^ |Tjj ^ Jfji (gi/gl & >&> ;i it 41 . The mutual increase diverts you,} 42 . Until you visit the graves. 43 . Nay! You shall come to know!} 44. Again nay! You shall come to know!} 45 . Nay! Ifyou knew with a sure biowledge.} 46 . Verily, you shall see the blazing Fire!} 47 . And again, you shall see it with certainty ofsight!} 45 . Then on that Day you shall be asked about the delights!} The Result ofLoving the Worldand Heedlessness ofthe Hereafter Allah says that all are preoccupied by love of the world, its delights and its adornments, and this distracts you from seeking the Hereafter and desiring it. This delays you until death comes to you and you visit the graves, thus becoming its inhabitants. In Sahlh Al-Bukhari, it is recorded in the Book of Ar-Riqaq (Narrations that soften the Heart) from Anas bin Malik, who reported that Ubayy bin Ka*b said, “We used to think that this was a part of the Qur’an until the Ayah was revealed which says;

577Surah 102. At-Takdthur (1-8) (Part-30) that the Messenger of Allah jg said, (3^ «Jti <i UjJj l^ : JLxJl l_r»UU aJJIj —&Ijj lilJi Syt (jj-iJ jf «77ie servant says “My wealth, my wealth.” Yet he only gets three (benefits)from his wealth : that which he eats andfinishes, that which he wears until it is wom out, or that which he gives in charity and it is spent. Everything else other than that will go away and leave him for the people.^ Muslim was alone in recording this Hadlth. Al-Bukhari recorded from Anas bin Malik that the Messenger of Allah said, i<LLc-j *JU_j *uf *** j0l^-’Ji olJl i*LLZ- tijlij dii «Three things follow the deceased person, and two of them return while one remains behind with him. The things which follow him are his family, his wealth and his deeds. His family and his wealth return while his deeds remain .»’2 This Hadlth has also been recorded by Muslim, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal.13 ’ Imam Ahmad recorded from Anas that the Prophet said, *The Son of Adam becomes old with senility, but yet two things remain with him: greed and /lope.®’4 ’ Both of them (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) recorded this Hadlth in the Two Sahihs.lS] Muslim 4:2273. Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :369 131 Muslim 4:2273, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:50, and An-Nasal in Al- Kubrd 6 :631 141 Ahmad 3:115. 151 Al-Bukhari no. 6421 , and Muslim no. 1047.

what has been reported in the narrations concerning it. Allah then says. ;* v iThen on that Day you shall be asked about the delights!\$ meaning, 'on that Day you all will be questioned concerning your gratitude towards the favors that Allah blessed you with, such as health, safety, sustenance and other things. You will be asked did you return His favors by being thankful to Him and worshipping Him.' Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Husayn bin 'Ali As-Suda'i narrated to him from Al-Walid bin Al-Qasim, who reported from Yazid bin Kaysan, who reported from Abi Hazim, who reported from Abu Hurayrah that he said, "Once while Abu Bakr and 'Umar were sitting, the Prophet s& came to them and said, 'What has caused you two to sit here? They replied, 'By He Who has sent you with the truth, nothing has brought us out of our houses except hunger.' The Prophet S& said, U JZ j'o» 'By He Who has sent me with the truth, nothing has brought me out other than this. So they went until they came to the house of a man from the Ansar, and the woman of the house received them. The Prophet said to her, «Where is so-and-so? She replied, 'He went to fetch some drinking water for us.' So the man came carrying his bucket and he said, Welcome. Nothing has visited the servants (of Allah) better than a Prophet who has visited me today.' Then he hung his bucket near a palm tree, and climbed it and returned to them with a cluster of dates. So the Prophet said, <?J4££l diS

580 Tafslr Ibn Kathir «lWhy didn't you pick (some of them)? The man replied, I wanted you to choose with your own eyes.' Then he took a blade (to slaughter a sheep) and the Prophet said, d'i!' «Do not slaughter one that gives milk. So he slaughtered a sheep for them that day and they all ate. Then the Prophet said, •You will be asked about this on the Day of Judgement. Hunger caused you to come out of your homes and you did not return until you had eaten this meal. So this is from the delights,n"*11 Muslim also recorded this HadithJ2 ' It has been confirmed in Sahih Al-Bukhdri and the Sunans of At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn MAjah from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger of Allah said, j owaJ I ;^LJI {j* j iTwo favors are treated unjustly by most people: health and free This means that the people are lacking gratitude for these two favors. They do fulfill their obligations to them. Therefore, whoever does not maintain the right that is obligatory upon him, then he is unjust. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet ^ said, j^Ji JU tfSi Jii - fcj> ii>i 111 At-Tabari 24:583. 121 Muslim 3 : 1609 •3| Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :233 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 6 :589 , Tuhfat Al-Ashmf 4 :465 , and Ibn M&jah 2 :1396

581Surah 102. At-Takathur (1-8) (Part-30) *Allah the Mighty and Majestic says on the Day ofJudgement, "O Son ofAdam! I made you ride upon the horses and camels, I gave you women to marry, and I made you reside and rule (in the earth). So where is the thanks for that Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith in this manner.

Surah 103: Al-Asr

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6528]

Opening 582 Tafstr Ibtx KathTr The Tafslr of Surat Al- Asr (Chapter - 103)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6528–6530]

How ‘Amr bin Al-‘As was aware of the Qur'an’s Miracle due to this Surah They have mentioned that ‘Amr bin Al-‘As went to visit Musaylimah Al-Kadhdhab after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was commissioned (as a Prophet) and before ‘Amr had accepted Islam. Upon his arrival, Musaylimah said to him, “What has been revealed to your friend (Muhammad ﷺ) during this time?” ‘Amr said, “A short and concise Surah has been revealed to him.” Musaylimah then said, “What is it?” ‘Amr replied; 4By Al-‘Asr. Verily, man is in loss. Except those who believe and do righteous deeds, and recommend one another to the truth, and recommend one another to patience. So Musaylimah thought for a while. Then he said, “Indeed something similar has also been revealed to me.” ‘Amr asked him, “What is it?” He replied, “O Wabr (a small, furry mammal; hyrax), O Wabr! You are only two ears and a chest, and the rest of you is digging and burrowing.” Then he said, “What do you think, O ‘Amr?” So ‘Amr said to him, “By Allah! Verily, you know that I know you are lying.” 11 ‘I saw that Abu Bakr Al-Kharrā’ī mentioned a chain of narration for part of this story, or what was close to its meaning, in volume two of his famous book *Masawī’ ul- Akhldq*. The Wabr is a small animal that resembles a cat, and HI He also mentioned it in *Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah* 6:320, and Al- Hafiz mentioned similar to it in *Al-Isabah* 3 : 225

the largest thing on it is its ears and its torso, while the rest of it is ugly. Musayli- mah intended by the composition of these nonsensical verses to produce something which would oppose the Qur’an. Yet, it was not even convin- cing to the idol wor- shipper of that time. At-Tabarani recor- ded from ‘Abdullah bin Hisn Abi Madlnah that he said, “Whenever two men from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah used to meet, they would not part until one of them had recited Surat Al-‘Asr in its entirety to the other, and one of them had given the greetings of peace to the other.” Ash-Shafil said, “If the people were to ponder on this Surah, it would be sufficient for them.” V \ Hr T§ + s'+ K ffl HU w asai%£ 31 ^p\AjJliJjSyj3\ , x /"» ^ // / /•^ > *•' . j— Cp JrtW 1 ' Cp <j SM In the Natne ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ly-*L c^jJI “jl j o[4 p 'j— 41. By Al-’Asr.} 42. Verily, man is in loss.} Al- Mujam Al-Awsat no . 5097, Majma'Al-Bahrayn.

43. Except those who believe and do righteous deeds, and recommend one another to the truth, and recommend one another to patience. Al-‘Asr is the time in which the movements of the Children of Adam occur, whether good or evil. Malik narrated from Zayd bin Aslam that he said, “It is the evening.” However, the first view is the popular opinion. Thus, Allah swears by this, that man is in *Khusr*, which means in loss and destruction. ijLZj]pc ^} 4Except those who believe and do righteous good deeds, So Allah makes an exception, among the species of man being in loss, for those who believe in their hearts and work righteous deeds with their limbs. \^} iAnd recommend one another to the truth,} This is to perform acts of obedience and avoid the forbidden things. iAnd recommend one another to patience.} meaning, with the plots, the evils, and the harms of those who harm people due to their commanding them to do good and forbidding them from evil.

Surah 104: Al-Humazah

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6531–6533]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Humazah (Chapter - 104) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. } 42 . Who /ws gathered wealth and counted it.} 43 . He thinks that his wealth will make him last forever!} 44. But no! Verily, he will be thrown into Al-Hutamah.} 45. And what will make you know what Al-Hutamdh is?} 46. The fire of Allah, Al-Muqadah,} 47. Which leaps up over the hearts.} 48. Verily, it shall Mu'sadah upon them,} 49. In pillars stretched forth.} Al-Hammaz refers to (slander) by speech, and Al-Lammaz refers to (slander) by action. This means that the person finds fault with people and belittles them. An explanation of this has already preceded in the discussion of Allah's statement. I'M-*— p i Hammaz, going about with slander} (68: 1 1) Ibn 'Abbas said, "Humazah Lumazah means one who reviles and disgraces (others)." ' Mujahid said, "Al-Humazah is with the hand and the eye, and Al-Lumazah is with the tongue." [il At-Tabari 24 :596.

587 Surah 104. Al-Humazdh (1-9) (Part-30) hearts while they are still alive." Then he said, "Indeed the torment will reach them." Then he cried. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, "It (the Fire) will devour every part of his body until it reaches his heart and comes to the level of his throat, then it will return to his body." Concerning Allah's statement, i0l £)> {Verily, it shall Mu'sadah upon them .} meaning, covering, just as was mentioned in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Balad (see 90:20). Then Allah says, {In pillars stretched forth.} "Atiyah Al-'Awfi said, "Pillars of Iron." As-Suddi said, "Made of fire." Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "He will make them enter pillars stretched forth, meaning there will be columns over them, and they will have chains on their necks, and the gates (of Hell) will be shut upon them." [2,

Surah 105: Al-Fil

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6534–6543]

Opening 588 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir The TafsirofSuratAl-FU (Chapter - 105) Whichwas revealed inMakkah i — Ji' Jt~ In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. &M iKf&» & &)J*£ pjg£i L& 41 . Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with the Owners of the Elephant?) 42. Did He not make their plotgo astray?) 43. And He sent against them birds, in flocks (Abdbtl.) 44. Striking them with stones of Sijjtl.) 45. And He made them like ' Asf', Ma'kul.) This is one of the favors Allah did for the Quraysh. He saved them from the People of the Elephant who had tried to tear down the KaTxah and wipe out all traces of its existence. Allah destroyed them, defeated them, thwarted their plans, made their efforts in vain and sent them back routed. They were people who were Christians, and thus, their religion was closer to the True Religion (Islam) than the idolatry of the Quraysh. However, this was a means of giving a sign and preparing the way for the coming of the Messenger of Allah 5^5. For verily, he was bom during that same year according to the most popular opinion. So the tongue of destiny was saying, “We will not help you, O people of Quraysh, because of any status you may have over the Ethiopians (Abyssinians). We are only helping you in order to defend the Ancient House (the Katah), which We will honor, magnify, and venerate by sending the unlettered Prophet, Muhammad the Finality of all Prophets.”

ASummary ofthe Story ofthe People ofthe Elephant This is the story of the people of the Elephant, in brief, and summarized. It has already been mentioned in the story of the People of the Ditch that Dhu NuWas, the last king of Himyar, a polytheist - was the one who ordered killing the People of the Ditch. They were Christians and their number was approximately twenty thousand. None of them except a man named Daws Dhu Thalaban escaped. He fled to Ash-Sham where he sought protection from Caesar, the emperor of Ash- Sham, who was also a Christian. Caesar wrote to An-Najashi, the king of Ethiopia (Abyssinia), who was closer to the home of the man. An-Najashi sent two governors with him: Ary&t and Abrahah bin As-Sabah Abu Yaksum, along with a great army. The army entered Yemen and began searching the houses and looting in search of the king of Himyar (Dhu Nuwas). Dhu Nuwas was eventually killed by drowning in the sea. Thus, the Ethiopians were free to rule Yemen, with Aryat and Abrahah as its governors. However, they continually disagreed about matters, attacked each other, fought each other and warred against each other, until one of them said to the other, “There is no need for our two armies to fight. Instead let us fight each other (in a duel) and the one who kills the other will be the ruler of Yemen.” So the other accepted the challenge and they held a duel. Behind each man was a channel of water (to keep either from fleeing). Aryat gained the upper hand and struck Abrahah with his sword, splitting his nose and mouth, and slashing his face. But ‘Atawdah, Abrahah’s guard, attacked

Aryat and killed him. Thus, Abrahah returned wounded to Yemen where he was treated for his injuries and recovered. He thus became the commander of the Abyssinian army in Yemen. Then the king of Abyssinia, An-Najashi wrote to him, blaming him for what had happened (between him and Aryat) and threatened him, saying that he swore to tread on the soil of Yemen and cut off his forelock. Therefore, Abrahah sent a messenger with gifts and precious objects to An-Najashi to appease him and flatter him, and a sack containing soil from Yemen and a piece of hair cut from his forelock. He said in his letter to the king, "Let the king walk upon this soil and thus fulfill his oath, and this is my forelock hair that I send to

you." When An-Najashi received this, he was pleased with Abrahah and gave him his approval. Then Abrahah wrote to An-Najashi saying that he would build a church for him in Yemen the like of which had never been built before. Thus, he began to build a huge church in San'a', tall and beautifully crafted and decorated on all sides. The Arabs called it Al-Qullays because of its great height, and because if one looked at it, his cap would be in danger of falling off as he tilted his head back. Then Abrahah Al-Ashram decided to force the Arabs to make their pilgrimage to this magnificent church, just as they had performed pilgrimage to the Ka'bah in Makkah. He announced this in his kingdom (Yemen), but it was rejected by the Arab tribes of 'Adnan and Qahtan. The Quraysh were infuriated by it, so much so that one of them journeyed to the church and entered it one night. He then relieved himself in the church and ran away (escaping the people). When its custodians saw what he had done, they reported it to their king, Abrahah, saying; "One of the Quraysh has done this in anger over their House in whose place you have appointed this church." Upon hearing this, Abrahah swore to march to the House of Makkah (the Ka'bah and destroy it stone by stone. Muqatil bin Sulayman mentioned that a group of young men from the Quraysh entered the church and started a fire in it on an extremely windy day. So the church caught on fire and collapsed to the ground. Due to this Abrahah prepared himself and set out with a huge and powerful army so that none might prevent him from carrying out his mission. He took along a great, powerful elephant that had a huge body the like of which had never been seen before. This elephant was called Mahmfid and it was sent to Abrahah from An-Najashi, the king of Abyssinia, particularly for this expedition. It has also been said that he had eight other elephants with him; their number was also reported to be twelve, plus the large one, MahmQd - and Allah knows best. Their intention was to use this big elephant to demolish the Ka'bah. They planned to do this by fastening chains to the pillars of the Ka'bah and placing the other ends around the neck of the elephant. Then they would make the elephant pull on them in order to tear down the walls of the Ka'bah all at one time. When the Arabs

heard of Abrahah's expedition, they considered it an extremely grave matter. They held it to be an obligation upon them to defend the Sacred House and repel whoever intended a plot against it. Thus, the noblest man of the people of Yemen and the greatest of their chiefs set out to face him (Abrahah). His name was Dhu Nafr. He called his people, and whoever would respond to his call among the Arabs, to go to war against Abrahah and fight in defense of the Sacred House. He called the people to stop Abrahah's plan to demolish and tear down the Ka'bah. So the people responded to him and they entered into battle with Abrahah, but he defeated them. This was due to Allah's will and His intent to honor and venerate the Ka'bah. Dhu Nafr was captured and taken along with the army of Abrahah. The army continued on its way until it came to the land of Khath'am where it was confronted by Nufayl bin Habib Al-Kath'ami along with his people, the Shahrani and Nahis tribes. They fought Abrahah but he defeated

them and captured Nufayl bin Habib. Initially he wanted to kill him, but he forgave him and took him as his guide to show him the way to Al-Hijaz. When they approached the area of At-Ta'if, its people - the people of Thaqlf - went out to Abrahah. They wanted to appease him because they were fearful for their place of worship, which they called Al-Lat. Abrahah was kind to them and they sent a man named Abu Righal with him as a guide. When they reached a place known as Al-Mughammas, which is near Makkah, they settled there. Then he sent his troops on a foray to capture the camels and other grazing animals of the Makkans, which they did, including about two hundred camels belonging to 'Abdul-Muttalib. The leader of this particular expedition was a man named Al-Aswad bin Mafsud. According to what Ibn Ishaq mentioned, some of the Arabs used to satirize him (because of the part he played in this historical incident). Then Abrahah sent an emissary named Hanatah Al-Himyari to enter Makkah, commanding him to bring the head of the Quraysh to him. He also commanded him to inform him that the king will not fight the people of Makkah unless they try to

prevent him from the destruction of the Ka'bah. Hanatah went to the city and he was directed to 'Abdul-Muttalib bin Hashim, to whom he relayed Abrahah's message. 'Abdul-Muttalib replied, "By Allah! We have no wish to fight him, nor are we in any position to do so. This is the Sacred House of Allah, and the house of His KhaM, Ibrahim, and if He wishes to prevent him (Abrahah) from (destroying) it, it is His House and His Sacred Place (to do so). And if He lets him approach it, by Allah, We have no means to defend it from him." So Hanatah told him, "Come with me to him (Abrahah)." And so 'Abdul-Muttalib went with him. When Abrahah saw him, he was impressed by him, because 'Abdul-Muttalib was a large and handsome man. So Abrahah descended from his seat and sat with him on a carpet on the ground. Then he asked his translator to say to him, "What do you need?" 'Abdul-Muttalib replied to the translator, "I want the king to return my camels which he has taken from me which are two hundred in number." Abrahah then told his translator to tell him, "I was impressed by you when I first saw you, but now I withdraw from you after you have spoken to me. You are asking me about two hundred camels which I have taken from you and you leave the matter of a house which is (the foundation of) your religion and the religion of your fathers, which I have come to destroy and you do not speak to me about it?" 'Abdul-Muttalib said to him, "Verily, I am the lord of the camels. As for the House, it has its Lord Who will defend it." Abrahah said, "I cannot be prevented (from destroying it)." 'Abdul-Muttalib answered, "Then do so." It is said that a number of the chiefs of the Arabs accompanied 'Abdul-Muttalib and offered Abrahah a third of the wealth of the tribe of Tihamah if he would withdraw from the House, but he refused and returned 'Abdul-Muttalib's camels to him. 'Abdul-Muttalib then returned to his people and ordered them to leave Makkah and seek shelter at the top of the mountains, fearful of the excesses which might be committed by the army against them. Then he took hold of the metal ring of the door of the Ka'bah, and along with a number of Quraysh, he called upon Allah to give them victory over Abrahah and his army. 'Abdul-Muttalib said, while hanging on

593 Surah 105. Al-Fil (1-5) (Part-30) to the ring of the Ka'bah's door, "There is no matter more important to any man right now than the defense of his livestock and property. So, O my Lord! Defend Your property. Their cross and their cunning will not be victorious over your cunning by the time morning comes." According to Ibn Ishaq, then 'Abdul-Muttalib let go of the metal ring of the door of the Ka'bah, and they left Makkah and ascended to the mountains tops. Muqatil bin Sulayman mentioned that they left one hundred animals (camels) tied near the Ka'bah hoping that some of the army would

take some of them without a right to do so, and thus bring about the vengeance of Allah upon themselves. When morning came, Abrahah prepared to enter the sacred city of Makkah. He prepared the elephant named Mahmud. He mobilized his army, and they turned the elephant towards the Ka'bah. At that moment Nufayl bin Habib approached it and stood next to it, and taking it by its ear, he said, "Kneel, Mahmud! Then turn around and return directly to whence you came. For verily, you are in the Sacred City of Allah." Then he released the elephant's ear and it knelt, after which Nufayl bin Habib left and hastened to the mountains. Abrahah's men beat the elephant in an attempt to make it rise, but it refused. They beat it on its head with axes and used hooked staffs to pull it out of its resistance and make it stand, but it refused. So they turned him towards Yemen, and he rose and walked quickly. Then they turned him towards Ash-Sham and he did likewise. Then they turned him towards the east and he did the same thing. Then they turned him towards Makkah and he knelt down again. Then Allah sent against them the birds from the sea, like swallows and herons. Each bird carried three stones the size of chickpeas and lentils, one in each claw and one in its beak: Everyone who was hit by them was destroyed, though not all of them were hit. They fled in panic along the road asking about the whereabouts of Nufayl that he might point out to them the way home. Nufayl, however, was at the top of the mountain with the Quraysh and the Arabs of the Hijaz observing the wrath which Allah had caused to descend on the people of the elephant. Nufayl then began to say, "Where will they flee when the One True God is the Pursuer? For Al-

Ashram is defeated and not the victor." Ibn Ishaq reported that Nufayl said these lines of poetry at that time, "Didn't you live with continued support? We favored you all with a revolving eye in the morning (i.e., a guide along the way). If you saw, but you did not see it at the side of the rock covered mountain that which we saw. Then you will excuse me and praise my affair, and do not grieve over what is lost between us. I praised Allah when I saw the birds, and I feared that the stones might be thrown down upon us. So all the people are asking about the whereabouts of Nufayl, as if I have some debt that I owe the Abyssinians." 'Ata' bin Yasar and others have said that all of them were not struck by the torment at this hour of retribution. Rather some of them were destroyed immediately, while others were gradually broken down limb by limb while trying to escape. Abrahah was of those who was broken down limb by limb until he eventually died in the land of Khath'am. Ibn Ishaq said that they left (Makkah) being struck down and destroyed along every path and at every water spring. Abrahah's body was afflicted by the pestilence of the stones and his army carried him away with them as he was falling apart piece by piece, until they arrived back in San'a\ When they arrived there he was but like the baby chick of a bird. And he did not die until his heart fell out of his chest. So they claim. Ibn Ishaq said that when Allah sent Muhammad with the prophethood, among the things that he used to recount to the Quraysh as blessings that Allah had favored them with of His bounties, was His defending them from the attack of the Abyssinians. Due to this they (the Quraysh) were allowed to remain (safely in Makkah) for a period of time. Thus, Allah said, iHaoe you not seen how your Lord dealt with the Owners of the Elephant? Did He not make their plot go astray? And He

595Surah 105. Al-Fil (1-5) (Part-30) sent against than birds, in flocks (Ababil). Striking them with stones of Sijjil. And He made than like 'Asf, Ma'kiil.} 'jl» 4>J 'jV. 'm'i 4For the Ilaf of the Quraysh, their llaf caravans, in winter and in summer. So, let them worship the Lord of this House, Who has fed than against hunger, and has made them safe from fear.} (106:1-4) meaning, that Allah would not alter

their situation because Allah wanted good for them if they accepted Him. Ibn Hisham said, “Al-AbabU are the groups, as the Arabs do not speak of just one (bird).” He also said, “As for As-SijjU, Yunus An-Nahwi and Abu TJbaydah have informed me that according to the Arabs, it means something hard and solid.” He then said, “Some of the commentators have mentioned that it is actually two Persian words that the Arabs have made into one word. The two words are Sanj and JiZ, Sanj meaning stones, and Jil meaning clay. The rocks are of these two types: stone and clay.” He continued saying, aAl-'Asfare the leaves of the crops that are not gathered. One of them is called ‘As/ah.” 11 ’ This is the end of what he mentioned. Hammad bin Salamah narrated from ‘Asim, who related from Zirr, who related from ‘Abdullah and Abu Salamah bin ‘Abdur- Rahman that they said, ibirds Abdbil “In groups.” Ibn ‘Abbas and Ad-Dahhak both said, “Abdbil means some of them following after others.” Al- Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah both said, “Abdbil means many.” Mujahid said, “Abdbil means in various, successive groups.” Ibn Zayd said, “Abdbil means different, coming from here and there. They came upon them from everywhere.”12’ Al-Kasai said, “I heard some of the grammarians saying, “The singular of Abdbil is IbH” Ibn Jarir recorded from Ishaq bin ‘Abdullah bin Al-Harith Ibn Hisham 1:51-56. 121 At-Tabari 24:605, 606.

bin Nawfal that he said concerning Allah’s statement, iAnd He sent against them birds, Ababil.i • “This means in divisions just as camels march in divisions (in their herds).” It is reported that Ibn ‘Abbas said, iAnd He sent against them birds, Abdbil “They had snouts like the beaks of birds and paws like the paws of dogs.”*2 * It has been reported that ‘Ikrimah said commenting on Allah’s state- ment, ibirds, Abdbil. “They were green birds that came out of the sea and they had heads like the heads of predatory animals.”*3 ’ It has been reported from Ubayd bin TJmayr that he commented: ik0 (M - ibirds, Abdbil. “They were black birds of the sea that had stones in their beaks and claws.”*4 ’ And the chains of narration (for these statements) are all authentic. It is reported from TJbayd bin TJmayr that he said, “When Allah wanted to destroy the People of the Elephant, he sent birds upon them that came from sea swallows. Each of the birds was carrying three small stones - two stones with its feet and one stone in its beak. They came until they gathered in rows over their heads. Then they gave a loud cry and threw what was in their claws and beaks. Thus, no stone fell upon the head of any man except that it came out of his behind (i.e., it went through him), and it did not fall on any part of his body except that it came out from the opposite side. Then Allah sent a severe wind that struck the stones and increased them in force. Thus, they were all destroyed.” Concerning Allah’s statement, I 1 ’ At-Tabari 24:606. * At-Tabari 24:607. At-Tabari 24:607. At-Tabari 24:607.

iAnd He made them like ‘Asf, Ma’kul.) Said bin Jubayr said, “This means straw, which the common people call Habbur.” In a report from Said he said, “The leaves of wheat.” 1 11 He also said, “Al-'Asfis straw, and Al-MaTad refers to the fodder that is cut for animals.” Al-Hasan Al-Basri said the same thing. Ibn ‘Abbas said, uAl-‘Asf is the shell of the grain, just like the covering of wheat.”*2 * Ibn Zayd said, “Al-'Asf are the leaves of vegetation and produce. When the cattle eat it they defecate it out and it becomes dung.”*3

The meaning of this is that Allah destroyed them,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6543–6544]

annihilated them and repelled them in their plan and their anger. They did not achieve any good. He made a mass destruction of them, and not one of them returned (to their land) to relate what happened except that he was wounded. This is just like what happened to their king, Abrahah. For indeed he was split open, exposing his heart when he reached his land of San'a. He informed the people of what happened to them and then he died. His son Yaqm became the king after him, and then Yaqm's brother, Masruq bin Abrahah succeeded him. Then Sayf bin Dhi Yazan Al-Himyari went to Kisra (the king of Persia) and sought his help against the Abyssinians. Therefore, Kisra dispatched some of his army with Sayf Al-Himyari to fight with him against the Abyssinians. Thus, Allah returned their kingdom to them (i.e., the Arabs of Yemen) along with all the sovereignty their fathers possessed. Then large delegations of Arabs came to him (Sayf Al-Himyari) to congratulate him for their victory.*4 We have mentioned previously in the Tafsir of Surat Al-Fath that when the Messenger of Allah[^] approached the mountain pass that would lead him to the Quraysh on the Day of Al-Hudaybiyyah, his she-camel knelt down. Then the people attempted to make her get up but she refused. So, the people said, "Al-Qaswa has become stubborn." The Prophet jg (1 * Ad-DurrAl-Mcmthur8:633. * Al-Baghawi 4 :529 * At-Jabari 24 :699 * See Sirah Ibn Hisham 1 :96-103.

replied, [j-it>- U— > ^ dij Uj i ìy.jiai\oVi U» «Al-Qasua' has not become stubborn, for that is not part of her character. Rather, she has been stopped by He Who restrained the Elephant (of Abrahah) .» Then he said, "VI 4)1 Li-j <Ja>- I L*-j 31 «/ swear by He in Whose Hand is my soul, they (the Quraysh) will not ask me for any matter (of the treaty) in which the sacred things of Allah are honored except that I will agree with them on itJ Then he beckoned the she-camel to rise and she stood upJ This Hadith is of those that Al-Bukhari was alone in recording. It has been recorded in the Two Sahls that on the Day of the conquest of Makkah, the Messenger of Allah sg said, OoIp Aj <jlj Jab, t ir~^ ^ j| ouii bdu gs> N't i o Verily, Allah restrained the Elephant from Makkah, and He has given His Messenger and the believers authority over it. And indeed its sacredness has returned just as it was sacred yesterday. So, let those who are present inform those who are absent. »|21

Surah 106: Quraysh

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6545–6547

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6545]

Opening Jr tfcWiSS VY The Tafslr of Surah Quraysh (Chapter - 106)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6545–6547]

"V i-sg« P ^ In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. .JLlif sfc, ^ oit Wl mm pjp ^14 (p .••r *« > - IB s ' •> y 1*. j_jaLv <!>\$ ^Cp 0_>c-CJ'o>*i*j)Ip Qj IT 31 . For the llaf of the Quraysh. 42. Their llaf caravans, in winter and in summer.} 43. So, let them worship the Lord of this House.} 44. Who has fed them against hunger, and has made them safe from fear.} This Surah has been separated from the one that preceded it in the primary Mushaf (the original copy of Tlthman). They (the Companions) wrote "In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful" on the line (i.e., the space) between these two Surahs. They did this even though this Surah is directly related to the one which precedes it, as Muhammad bin Ishaq and 'Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin 0 0ZF&Z&Kk o'

Aslam have both clarified. This is because the meaning of both of them is, "We have prevented the Elephant from entering Makkah and We have destroyed its people in order to gather (ilaf) the Quraysh, which means to unite them and bring them together safely in their city." It has also been said that the meaning of this {hajj} is what they would gather during their journey in the winter to Yemen and in the summer to Ash-Sham through trade and other than that. Then they would return to their city in safety during their journeys due to the respect that the people had for them because they were the residents of Allah's sanctuary. Therefore, whoever knew them would honor them. Even those who came to them and traveled with them, would be safe because of them. This was their situation during their journeys and travels during their winter and summer. In reference to their living in the city, then it is as Allah said, osS® &££ 8 ! iHave they not seen that We have made it a secure sanctuary, while men are being snatched away from all around them?} (29 :67) Thus, Allah says, ih? iFor the hafof the Quraysh. Their Ilaf} This is a subject that has been transferred from the first sentence in order to give it more explanation. Thus, Allah says, iTheir Ilaf caravans, in winter and in summer.} Ibn Jarir said, "The correct opinion is that the letter Lam is a prefix that shows amazement. It is as though He (Allah) is saying. You should be amazed at the uniting (or taming) of the Quraysh and My favor upon them in that.' " He went on to say, "This is due to the consensus of the Muslims that they are two separate and independent Surahs." Then Allah directs them to be grateful for this magnificent favor in His saying,

iSo, let them worship the Lord of this House .> meaning, then let them single Him out for worship, just as He has given them a safe sanctuary and a Sacred House. This is as Allah says, 41 have been commanded only to worship the Lord of this city, Who has sanctified it and to Whom belongs everything. And I am commanded to befrom among the Muslims.> (27:91) Then Allah says, ie J ^ *Aj i+v*- »j is43 4W7io has fed them against hunger,) meaning, He is the Lord of the House and He is the One Who feeds them against hunger. has made them safe from fear.) meaning, He favors them with safety and gentleness, so they should single Him out for worship alone, without any partner. They should not worship any idol, rival or statue besides Him. Therefore, whoever accepts this command, Allah will give him safety in both this life and the Hereafter. However, whoever disobeys Him, He will remove both ofthem from him. This is as Allah says. j: \xc-j i+sjj 14^. XL.1LZ Xlf. 4^=. 'iff^ fffj) \y\£- => Lj ijyiJiiJ J*Q iif 4LI jfit o &4.0 ^ <4And Allah puts forward the example ofa township, that dwelt secure and well-content: its provision coming to it in abundance from every place, but it denied the favors of Allah. So, Allah made it taste extreme of hunger and fear, because of that which they used to do. And verily, there had come unto them a Messenger from among themselves, but they denied him, so the torment overtook them while they were wrongdoers.) (16:112-113)

Surah 107: Al-Maun

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6548–6551]

Opening 602 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Tafsir of Surat Al-Ma'un (Chapter - 107) Which was revealed in Makkah in the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. < ' - J t- o* 05^4 J-r*y 4p0lp3&Z, 41 . Have you seen him who denies Ad-Din? } 42. That is he who repulses the orphan, } 43. And urges not the feeding of Al-Miskin . } 44. So, woe unto those performers of Salah, } 45. Those who with their Salah are Sahun . } 46. Those who do good deeds only to be seen, } 47. And withhold Al-Ma'in. } Allah says, "O Muhammad! Have you seen the one who denies the Din?" Here the word Din means the Hereafter, the Recompense and the Final Reward. 4 That in he who repulses the orphan, } meaning, he is the one who oppresses the orphan and does not give him his just due. He does not feed him, nor is he kind to him. &% } 4 And urges not the feeding of Al-Miskin . } This is as Allah says, P v St 4 Nay! But you treat not the orphans with kindness and generosity! And urge not one another on the feeding of Al-

Mistin'. } (89:17-18) meaning, the poor man who has nothing to sustain him and suffice his needs. Then Allah says, itS&ptz H'P' & c* Xf' } i So, woe unto those performers of Salah, those who with their Salah are Sahun. } Ibn 'Abbas and others have said, "This means the hypocrites who pray in public but do not pray in private." 111 Thus, Allah says, i unto those performers of Salah, } They are those people who pray and adhere to the prayer, yet they are mindless of it. This may either be referring to its act entirely, as Ibn 'Abbas said, or it may be referring to performing it in its stipulated time that has been legislated Islamically. This means that the person prays it completely outside of its time. This was said by Masruq and Abu Ad-Duha. 121 'Ata' bin Dinar said, "All praise is due to Allah, the One Who said, i with their Salah are Sahun. } and He did not say, those who are absent minded in their prayer.' It could also mean the first time of the prayer, which means they always delay it until the end of its time, or they usually do so. It may also refer to not fulfilling its pillars and conditions, and in the required manner. It could also mean performing it with humility and contemplation of its meanings. The wording of the Ayah comprises all of these meanings. However, whoever has any characteristic of this that we have mentioned then a portion of this Ayah applies to him And whoever has all of these characteristics, then he has completed his share of this Ayah, and the hypocrisy of actions is fulfilled in him. This is just as is confirmed in the Two At-Tabari 24:632. At-Tabari 24:631. 131 Al-Qurpibi 20:212.

605 Surah 107. Al-Ma'un (1-7) (Part-30) heard 'Abdullah bin 'Amr saying that the Messenger of Allah M said, to j&f-J o *u 4) 1 ' ^*U3l V tlATioeuer tries to make the people hear of his deed, Allah, the One Who hears His creation, will hear it and make him despised and degraded . n"* 1 from what is related to his statement, 4 Those who do good deeds only to be seen. } is that whoever does a deed solely for

Allah, but the people come to know about it, and he is pleased with that, then this is not considered showing off. Allah said: iAnd withhold Al-Ma'un.) This means that they do not worship their Lord well, nor do they treat His creation well. They do not even lend that which others may benefit from and be helped by, even though the object will remain intact and be returned to them. These people are even stingier when it comes to giving Zakdh and different types of charity that bring one closer to Allah. Al-Masfadi narrated from Salamah bin Kuhayl who reported from Abu Al-TJbaydln that he asked Ibn Masfad about Al- Ma'un and he said, "It is what the people give to each other, like an axe, a pot, a bucket and similar items."*2

Surah 108: Al-Kawthar

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6552–6557

The Tafsir of Surat Al-Kawthar

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6552–6557]

(Chapter - 108) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah and They also say in In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 11 . Verily, We have granted you Al-Kawthar.} 12. Therefore him in prayer to your Lord and sacrifice.} 43. For he who hates you, he will be cut off.} Muslim, Abu Dawud and An-Nasal, all recorded from Anas' that he said, "While we were with the Messenger of Allah jg in the Masjid, he dozed off into a slumber. Then he lifted his head smiling. We said, 'O Messenger of Allah! What has caused you to laugh?' He said, iVerily, a Surah was just revealed to me. Then he recited. iVerily, We have granted you Al-Kawthar. Therefore him in prayer to your Lord and sacrifice. For he who hates you, he will be ait' off.} Then he said, u 'jjxU «Do you all know what is Al-Kawthar?» ' 1 ' Muslim 1:300, Abu Dawud 5:110, and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra

607Surah 108. Al-Kawthar (1-3) (Part-30) We said, 'Allah and His Messenger know best.' He said, fji V >* 'j=S j5>- Up 'Jtj M» : Jj»(i jlxJI ^ ijLf- 4^i! (oUoll ulSjby U ^ ilil 4jl tVerily, it is a river that my Lord, the Mighty and Majestic, has promised me and it has abundant goodness. It is a pond where my Ummah will be brought to on the Day ofJudgement. Its containers are as numerous as the stars in the sky. Then a servant of Allah from among them will be (prevented from it) and I will say: "O Lord! Verily, he is from my Ummah (followers)." Then He (Allah) will say: "Verily, you do not know wluit he introduced (or innovated) after yoM.u" This is the wording of Muslim. Ahmad recorded this Hadith from Muhammad bin Fudayl, who reported from Al-Mukhtar bin Fulfill, who reported it from Anas bin Malik.12 ' Imam Ahmad also recorded from Anas that the Messenger of Allah jg said, lj> J) C-j'j~ai j&j Ul <L>Jl cJji-Sn **<' ' ' ' - 1 Ji - 4^lkp1 l l-Ls ;JU 1-iaU : oJj t :L.J «>3> Shi «/ entered Paradise and I came to a river whose banks had tents made of pearls. So I thrust my hand into its flowing water and found that it was the strongest (smell) of musk. So I asked, "O Jibnl! What is this?" He replied, "This is Al-Kawthar which Allah, the Mighty and Majestic has given yow."®'3 ' Al-Bukhari recorded this in his Sahih, and so did Muslim, on the authority of Anas bin Malik. In their version Anas said, "When the Prophet jg was taken up to the heaven, he said, ili : Jii u iju u :JLa jijui 4,12 £ JU cJf» ' ' * # 111 MusUm 1 :300. Ahmad 3:102. Ahmad 3:103.

ft*!' «I came to a river whose banks had domes of hollowed pearl. I said: "O Jibril! What is this?" He replied: "This is Al- Kawthar . This is the wording of Al-Bukhari. Ahmad recorded from Anas that a man said, "O Messenger of Allah! What is Al-Kawthar?" He replied. 4J i ' Jl fyy «jyJl ijlipls' LfSlui «lt is a river in Paradise which my Lord has given me. It is whiter than milk and sweeter than honey. There are birds in it whose necks are (long) like carrotsJ Umar said, "O Messenger of Allah! Verily, they (the birds) will be beautiful." The Prophet jg replied, tyj. u; jUif «7?ie one who eats them (i.e., the people of

Paradise) will be more beautiful than them, O 'Umar²] Al-Bukhari recorded from Said bin Jubayr that Ibn 'Abbas said about Al-Kawthar, "It is the good which Allah gave to him (the Prophet)." Abu Bishr said, "I said to Said bin Jubayr, Verily, people are claiming that it is a river in Paradise.' " Said replied, The river which is in Paradise is part of the goodness which Allah gave him.' "I³) Al-Bukhari also recorded from Said bin Jubayr that Ibn 'Abbas said, "Al-Kawthar is the abundant goodness."|⁴ This explanation includes the river and other things as well. Because the word Al-Kawthar comes from the word Kathrah (abundance) and it (Al-Kawthar linguistically means an abundance of goodness. So from this goodness is the river (in Paradise). Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn Umar that the Messenger of Allah said, I 1 * Al-Bukharino . 4946. 121 Ahmad 3:220. 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :603 141 At-Tabari 24:647.

J_-f ojlij 'LJlj obib*- 4i>jl <_,» «J^jl Off 'o£* Off 1Al-Kawthar is a river in Paradise whose banks are of gold and it runs over pearls. Its water is whiter than milk and sweeter than honeyj This Hadith was recorded in this manner by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah, Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. At-Tirmidhi said. "Hasan Satth;TM Then Allah says, T,>^J ^a*) iTherefore turn in prayer to your Lord and sacrifice.) meaning, just as We have given you the abundant goodness in this life and the Hereafter - and from that is the river that has been described previously - then make your obligatory and optional prayer, and your sacrifice (of animals) solely and sincerely for your Lord. Woship Him alone and do not associate any partner with him. And sacrifice pronouncing His Name alone, without ascribing any partner to Him.' This is as Allah says. k acj are 4^; k fo iSay: "Verily, my Salah, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying are for Alim, the Lord of all that exists. He has no partner. And of this I have been commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims.") (6:162-163) Ibn 'Abbas, 'Ata,' Mujahid, 'Ikrimah and Al-Hasan all said, "This means with this the Budn should be sacrificed."*³¹ Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi, Ad-Dahhak, Ar- Rabl', 'Ata' Al-Khurasani, Al-Hakam, Ismail bin Abi Khalid and others from the Salaf have all said the same.'⁴ ' This is the [1 * Ahmad 2 :67. See Al-Bukhari 4965. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:294, Ibn Majah 2:1450, and At-Tabari At-Tabari 24 :653 At-Tabari 24 :654

611Surah 108. Al-Kawthar (1-3) (Part-30 all are better than him.' So Allah revealed, iFor he who hates you, he will be cut off.y This is how Al-Bazzar recorded this incident and its chain of narration is authentic.' It has been reported that 'Ata' said, "This Surah was revealed about Abu Lahab when a son of the Messenger of Allah jg died. Abu Lahab went to the idolators and said, 'Muhammad has been cut off (i.e., from progeny) tonight.' So concerning this Allah revealed, 4For he wlv hates you, he will be cut off.}" As-Suddi said, "When the made sons of a man died the people used to say, *He has been cut off.' So, when the sons of the Messenger of Allah sg died they said, 'Muhammad has been cut off.' Thus, Allah revealed, iFor he who hates you, he will be cut off.y So they thought in their ignorance that if his sons died, his remembrance would be cut off. Allah forbid! To the contrary, Allah preserved his remembrance for all the world to see, and He obligated all the servants to follow his Law. This will continue for all of time until the Day of Gathering and the coming of the Hereafter. May the blessings of Allah and His peace be upon him forever until the Day of Assembling.

Surah 109: Al-Kafirun

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6558–6562]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Qulyd Ayyuhal-Kdfirun (Chapter - 109) Which was revealed in Makkah The Recitation of these Surahs in the Optional Prayers It has been confirmed in Sahih Muslim from Jabir that the Messenger of Allah jg recited this Surah (Al-Kdfirun) and iii J»^ iSay: "He is Allah One."} (112:1) in the two Rak'ahs of Taw&f) l] It is also recorded in Sahih. Muslim in a Hadtth of Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah jgg recited these two Surahs in the two Rak'ahs (optional prayer) of the Morning prayer. ,2! Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn Umar that the Messenger of Allah recited in the two Rak'ahs before the Morning prayer and the two Rak'ahs after the Sunset prayer on approximately ten or twenty different occasions, it iSay "O Al-Kafirun!"} and iSay: "He is Allah One."} (112:1)<31 Ahmad also recorded that Ibn Umar said, "I watched the Prophet igg twenty-four or twenty-five times reciting in the two Rak'ahs before the Morning prayer and the two Rak'ahs after the Sunset prayer, I1 * Muslim 2 :888 in a lengthy Hadlth. I2 * Muslim 1 :502 I3 ' Ahmad 2 :24 and 58.

0&Z>h.s%0ZfcuifZft; ^dii<;V30 <><' /."ft if • -t> ijJujJLt-^i-yc ^ OJ L.U*ldHI/i->.ai tv • jUa-Jb 3! 3! 4-Sjy^Jc^TlfO ~Tal£. 4Sj^ii Qk iSay: "O Al-Kafirun , /> and 41^1 it 4Say: "He is Allah One."> (1 12:1) m|1 Ahmad recorded that Ibn 'Umar said, "I watched the Prophet 2g for a month and he would recite in the two Rak'ahs before the Morning prayer, Al-iSay: "O Kafirun."^ and it Z tj iSay: "He is Allah One."} (1 12: 1)"*2' This was also recor- ded by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Majah and An- Nasal. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan. "(31 It has already been mentioned previously in a Hadith that it (Surat Al-Kafirun^ is equivalent to a fourth of the Qur'dn and Az-Zalzalah is equivalent to a fourth of the Qur'an. Z-Z# p In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Z £S# ? 0S^J{ Qk iOim# z 6 it 111 Ahmad 2 :99 ,2) Ahmad 2 :94 * TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 2 :470, Ibn Majah 1 :363, and An-Nas&l 2 :170.

41. Say: "O disbelievers!"} 42 . "I worship not that which you worship."4 43. "Nor will you worship whom I worship."} 44. "And I shall not worship that which you are worshipping."} 45. "Nor will you worship that which I worship."} 46. "To you be your religion, and to me my religion."} The Declaration of Innocence from Shirk This Surah is the Surah of disavowal from the deeds of the idolaters. It commands a complete disavowal of that. Allah's statement, 4Say: "O disbelievers!"} includes every disbeliever on the face of the earth, however, this statement is particularly directed towards the disbelievers of the Quraysh. It has been said that in their ignorance they invited the Messenger of Allah jg to worship their idols for a year and they would (in turn) worship his God for a year. Therefore, Allah revealed this Surah and in it He commanded His Messenger sg to disavow himself from their religion completely. Allah said, 41 worship not that which you worship.} meaning, statues and rival gods. 4Nor will you worship whom I worship.} and He is Allah Alone, Who has no

partner. So the word Ma (what) here means Man (who). Then Allah says. S VJ t jf 0%} 4And I shall not worship that which you are worshipping. Nor will you worship whom I worship.} meaning, T do not worship according to your worship, which means that I do not go along with it or follow it. 1 only worship Allah in the manner in which He loves and is pleased with.' Thus, Allah says,

• - r' ' > ' T ,JL*I U OJJULc a na 4Nor will you worship whom I worship.} meaning, “you do not follow the commands of Allah and His Legislation in His worship. Rather, you have invented something out of the promptings of your own souls.’ This is as Allah says, 4They follow but a guess and that which they themselves desire, whereas there has surely come to them the guidance from their Lord!} (53:23) Therefore, the disavowal is from all of what they are involved. For certainly the worshipper must have a god whom he worships and set acts of worship that he follows to get to him. So the Messenger jg and his followers worship Allah according to what He has legislated. This is why the statement of Islam is “There is no God worthy of being worshipped except Allah, and Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.” This means that there is no (true) object of worship except Allah and there is no path to Him (i.e., way of worshipping Him) other than that which the Messenger came with. The idolators worship other than Allah, with acts of worship that Allah has not allowed. This is why the Messenger jg said to them, 'S3} 4To you be your religion, and to me my religion.} This is similar to Allah’s statement, *4 &} 4And if they belie you, say: “For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!”} (10:41) and He said, 4pfX\ pj '\$} 4To us our deeds, and to you your deeds.} (28:55) Al-Bukhari said, “It has been said, <&i

616 TafsTr Van Kathir 4To you be your religion.} means disbelief. 4<ind to me my religion.} means, Islam.

Surah 110: An-Nasr

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

PDF pages: 6563–6567

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6563–6566]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat An-Nasr (Chapter - 110) Which was revealed in Al-Madinah The Virtues of Surat An-Nasr It has been mentioned previously that it (Surat An-Nasr) is equivalent to one-fourth of the Qur'an and that Surat Az-Zalzalah is equivalent to one-fourth of the Qur'an. An-Nasr recorded from 'Ubaydullah bin 'Abdullah bin Utbah that Ibn 'Abbas said to him, "O Ibn 'Utbah! Do you know the last Surah of the Qur'an that was revealed?" He answered, "Yes, it was iWhen there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest.} (110 : 1)" He (Ibn 'Abbas) said, "You have spoken truthfully." 4g>< P *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. p it& 4 Jidit if 41 . When there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest.} 42. And you see that the people enter Allah's religion in crowds.} 43. So, glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Who accepts the repentance and Who forgives.} [il An-Nasr in Al-Kubrd 6 :525

6M Tafsir Ibn Kathir This Surah informs of the Completion of the Life of Allah's Messenger Al-Bukhari recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "Umar used to bring me into the gatherings with the old men of (the battle of) Badr. However, it was as if one of them felt something in himself (against my attending). So he said, "Why do you (Umar) bring this (youth) to sit with us when we have children like him (i.e., his age)?" So Umar replied, 'Verily, he is among those whom you know.' Then one day he called them and invited me to sit with them, and I do not think that he invited me to be among them that day except to show them. So he said, What do you say about Allah's statement, fy} iWhen there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest.}?" Some of them said, We were commanded to praise Allah and seek His forgiveness when He helps us and gives us victory.' Some of them remained silent and did not say anything. Then he (Umar) said to me, Is this what you say, O Ibn 'Abbas?" I said, 'No.' He then said, What do you say?" I said, *It was the end of the life of Allah's Messenger that Allah was informing him of. Allah said, iWhen there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest.} which means, that is a sign of the end of your life. r.i* A iSo, glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Who accepts the repentance and Who forgives.' So, Umar bin Al-Khattab said, *1 do not know anything about it other than what you have said.' "" 1! Al-Bukhari was alone in recording this Hadith. Imam Ahmad recorded from Ibn 'Abbas that he said, "When m Fath Al-Bari 8:606.

4@£L3Vj& 4When there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest.} was revealed, the Messenger of Allah jg said, "err* c)\ «My death has been announced to me . And indeed he died during that year." ' Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadith. Al-Bukhari recorded that 'A'ishah said, "The Messenger of Allah jg used to say often in his bowing and prostrating, «Glory to You, O Allah, our Lord, and praise be to You. O Allah, forgive me.»'2' He did this as his interpretation of the Qur'an (i.e., showing its

implementation).” The rest of the group has also recorded this Hadith except for At-Tirmidhi.¹³ Imam Ahmad recorded from Masrviq that ‘A’ishah said, “The Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to often say towards the end of his life, *«Glory to Allah, and praise be unto Him. I seek Allah’s forgiveness and I repent to Him.»* And he said, *«Verily, my Lord has informed me that I will see a sign in my Ummah and He has commanded me that when I see it, I should glorify His praises and seek His forgiveness, for He is the One Who accepts repentance. And indeed I have seen it (i.e., the sign). When there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest (Al-Fath). And you see that the people enter Allah’s religion in crowds. So glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Who accepts the repentance and Who forgives.»* Muslim also recorded this HadithP

121 FathAl-Bari 8:605. ' Muslim 1 :350 , Abu Dawud 1 :546 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :525 and Ibn Majah 1 :287.

« Verily, my Lord has informed me that I will see a sign in my Ummah and He has commanded me that when I see it, I should glorify His praises and seek His forgiveness, for He is the One Who accepts repentance. And indeed I have seen it (i.e., the sign). When there comes the help of Allah and the Conquest (Al-Fath). And you see that the people enter Allah's religion in crowds. So glorify the praises of your Lord, and ask His forgiveness. Verily, He is the One Who accepts the repentance and Who forgives. Muslim also recorded this HadithP

The meaning of Al-Fath here is the conquest of Makkah, and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6566–6567]

there is only one view concerning it. For indeed the different areas of the Arabs were waiting for the conquest of Makkah before they would accept Islam. They said, “If he (Muhammad ﷺ) is victorious over his people, then he is a (true) Prophet.” So when Allah gave him victory over Makkah, they entered into the religion of Allah (Islam) in crowds. Thus, two years did not pass (after the conquest of Makkah) before the peninsula of the Arabs was laden with faith. And there did not remain any of the tribes of the Arabs except that they professed (their acceptance) of Islam. And all praise and blessings are due to Allah. Al-Bukhari recorded in his SahO that ‘Amr bin Salamah said, “When Makkah was conquered, all of the people rushed to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ to profess their Islam. The various regions were delaying their acceptance of Islam until Makkah was conquered. The people used to say, “Leave him and his people alone. If he is victorious over them he is a (true) Prophet.’ ”¹³ We have researched the war expedition for conquest of Makkah in our book As-Sirah. Therefore, whoever wishes he may review it there. And all praise and blessings are due to Allah. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu ‘Ammar that a neighbor of Jabir bin ‘Abdullah told him, “I returned from a journey and Jabir bin ‘Abdullah came and greeted me. So I began to talk 111 Ahmad 6:35. |a| Muslim 1 :351 131 FathAl-B&ri 7:616.

with him about the divisions among the people and what they had started doing. Thus, Jabir began to cry and he said, I heard the Messenger of Allah saying, * <&> ja Jt i oi» iVerily, the people have entered into the religion of Allah in crowds and they will also leave it in crowds.*’**’

Surah 111: Al-Masad

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6568–6573]

Opening i-jt-iz <jj> «Verily, I am a wamer (sent) to you all before the coming of a severe torment .» Then Abu Lahab said, “Have you gathered us for this? May you perish!” Thus, Allah revealed, y2 <i ^ iPerish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish he!} to the end of the Surah. 1 ’ In another narration it states that he stood up dusting of his hands and said, “Perish you for the rest of this day! Have you gathered us for this?” Then Allah revealed, y-** dj*^ iPerish the two Iwnds of Abu Lahab and perish he!} The first part is a supplication against him and the second is information about him. This man Abu Lahab was one of the uncles of the Messenger of Allah sgg. His name was ‘Abdul-TJzza bin Abdul-Muttalib. His surname was Abu TJtaybah and he was only called Abu Lahab because of the brightness of his face. He used to often cause harm to the Messenger of Allah 3g. He hated and scorned him and his religion. Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu Az-Zinad that a man called RabPah bin ‘Abbad from the tribe of Bani Ad-Dll, who was a man of pre-Islamic ignorance who accepted Islam, said to him, “I saw the Prophet 3^5 in the time of pre-Islamic ignorance in the market of Dhul-Majaz and he was saying, «l 5il 3j i : I)) 1# i;» “O people! Say there is no god worthy ofworship except Allah and you will be successful .» The people were gathered around him and behind him there was a man with a bright face, squint (or cross) eyes and two braids in his hair. Hewas saying, “Verily, he is an apostate (from our religion) and a liar!”Thismanwas following him (the Prophet 5^5) around wherever he went. So, I asked who was he and (1) FathAl-BOri 8:609.

they (the people) said, “This is his uncle, Abu Lahab.” Ahmad also recorded this narration from Surayj, who reported it from Ibn Abu Az-Zinad, who reported it from his father (Abu Zinad) who mentioned this same narration. However in this report, Abu Zinad said, “I said to Rabl'ah, ‘Were you a child at that time?’ He replied, ‘No. By Allah, that day I was most intelligent, and I was the strongest blower of the flute (for music).’”² Ahmad was alone in recording this Hadlth. Concerning Allah’s statement, Cj Jj’c £3 t} 4His wealth and his children (Kasab) will not benefit him!} Ibn ‘Abbas and others have said, 4s— &j} iand his children (Kasab) will not benefit him!} “Kasab means his children.”³ * A similar statement has been reported from ‘A’ishah, Mujahid, ‘Ata’, Al-Hasan and Ibn Sirin.⁴1 It has been mentioned from Ibn Mas’ud that when the Messenger of Allah jg called his people to faith, Abu Lahab said, “Even if what my nephew says is true, I will ransom myself (i.e., save myself) from the painful torment on the Day of Judgement with my wealth and my children.” Thus, Allah revealed, aS 1} 4His wealth and his children will not benefit him!} Then Allah says, £fS!3f£S£> 4He will enter a Fire full offlames!} meaning, it has flames, evil and severe burning. [1 * Ahmad 4:341. * Ahmad 4:341 At-Tabari 24:677. * At-Tabari 24:677.

The Destiny of Umm Jamil, the Wife of Abu Lahab and his wife too, who carries wood.} His wife was among the leading women of the Quraysh and she was known as Umm Jamil. Her name was 'Arwah bint Harb bin Umayyah and she was the sister of Abu Sufyan. She was supportive of her husband in his disbelief, rejection and obstinacy. Therefore, she will be helping to administer his punishment in the fire of Hell on the Day of Judgement. Thus, Allah says, iWho carries wood. In her neck is a twisted rope of Masad.} meaning, she will carry the firewood and throw it upon her husband to increase that which he is in (of torment), and she will be ready and prepared to do so. 'fe- 4\$ iln her neck is a twisted rope of Masad.} Mujahid and T Jrwah both said, "From the palm fiber of the Fire."111 Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, 'Atiyah Al-Jadali, Ad- Dahhak and Ibn Zayd that she used to place thorns in the path of the Messenger of Allah Al-Jawhari said, uAl-Masad refers to fibers, it is also a rope made from fibers or palm leaves. It is also made from the skins of camels or their furs. It is said (in Arabic) Masadtul-Habla and Amsaduhu Masadan, when you tightly fasten its twine." Mujahid said, £ 3-?- iZ-fc iln her neck is a twisted rope of Masad.} "This means a collar of iron."*21 Don't you see that the Arabs call a pulley cable a Masad? 111 Ad-Durr Al-Mcmthur 8:667. At-Tabari 24 :681

A Story of Abu Lahab's Wife harming the Messenger of Allah sg Ibn Abi Hatim said that his father and Abu Zur'ah both said that 'Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr Al-Humaydi told them that Sufyan informed them that Al-Walid bin Kathir related from Ibn Tadrus who reported that Asma' bint Abi Bakr said, "When J) tu APerish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish he)!\$ was revealed, the one-eyed Umm Jamil bint Harb came out wailing, and she had a stone in her hand. She was saying, 'He criticizes our father, and his religion is our scorn, and his command is to disobey us.' The Messenger of Allah jg was sitting in the Masjid (of the Ka'bah and Abu Bakr was with him. When Abu Bakr saw her he said, 'O Messenger of Allah! She is coming and I fear that she will see you.' The Messenger of Allah replied, V> l) 1*!« « Verily, she will not see ?nej Then he recited some of the Qur'an as a protection for himself. This is as Allah says. && h 1\$ v0 iAnd when you recite the Qur'an, We put between you and those who believe not in the Hereafter, an invisible veil (17 :45) So she advanced until she was standing in front of Abu Bakr and she did not see the Messenger of Allah jg. She then said, 'O Abu Bakr! Verily, I have been informed that your friend is making defamatory poetry about me.' Abu Bakr replied, 'Nay! By the Lord of this House (the Ka'bah) he is not defaming you.' So she turned away saying, Indeed the Quraysh know that I am the daughter of their leader.' " Al-Walid or another person said in a different version of this HadSth, "So Umm Jamil stumbled over her waist gown while she was making circuits (Tawaf) around the House (the Ka'bah) and she said, 'Cursed be the reviler.' Then Umm

Hakim bint 'Abdul-Muttalib said, 1 am a chaste woman so I will not speak abusively and I am refined so I do not know. Both of us are children of the same uncle. And after all the Quraysh know best."!

Surah 112: Al-Ikhlās

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Volume(s): 10

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The Tafsirof SuratAl-Ikhlās

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 6574]

(Chapter - 112) Which was revealed in Makkah

The Reason for the Revelation of Surah and its

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6574–6583]

Virtues Imam Ahmad recorded from Ubayy bin Ka'b that the idolaters said to the Prophet ﷺ, "O Muhammad! Tell us the lineage of your Lord." So Allah revealed in the Qur'an: "He is Allah, One. Allah He begets not, nor was He begotten. And there is none comparable to Him." [1] Similar was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Jarir and they added in their narration that he said. "As-Samad is One Who does not give birth, nor was He born, because there is nothing that is born except that it will die, and there is nothing that dies except that it leaves behind inheritance, and indeed Allah does not die and He does not leave behind any inheritance. And there is none comparable to Him." [2] This means that there is none similar to Him, none equal to Him and there is nothing at all like Him." [3] Ibn Abi Hatim also recorded it and At-Tirmidhi mentioned it as a Mursal narration. Then At-Tirmidhi said, "And this is the Ahmad 5:133. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :299 , and Af-Tabari 24 :691

629 Surah 112. Al-Ikhlās (1-4) (Part-30 most correct." A Hadith on its Virtues Al-Bukhari reported from 'Amrah bint 'Abdur-Rahman, who used to stay in the apartment of 'A'ishah, the wife of the Prophet ﷺ, that 'A'ishah said, "The Prophet sent me as the commander of a war expedition and he used to lead his companions in prayer with recitation (of the Qur'an). And he would complete his recitation with the recitation of 'Say: He is Allah, One.' So when they returned they mentioned that to the Prophet ﷺ and he said, 'Ask him why does he do that.' So they asked him and he said, 'Because it is the description of Ar-Rahman and I love to recite it. So the Prophet said, 'Inform him that Allah the Most High loves him.' This is how Al-Bukhari recorded this Hadith in his Book of Tawhid [4] * Muslim and An-Nasai also recorded it. In his Book of Salawat, Al-Bukhari recorded that Anas said, "A man from the Ansar used to lead the people in prayer in the Masjid of Quba'. Whenever he began a Surah in the recitation of the prayer that he was leading them, he would start by reciting 'Say: He is Allah, One' until he completed the entire Surah. Then he would recite another Surah along with it (after it). And used to do this in every Rak'ah. So his companions spoke to him about this saying; Verily, you begin the prayer with this Surah. Then you think that it is not sufficient for you unless you recite another Surah as well. So you should either recite it or leave it and recite another Surah instead.' The man replied, 'I will not leave it off. If you want me to continue leading you (in prayer), I will do this; and if you all do not like

it, I will leave you (i.e., I will stop leading you).’ *** That is, the narration that is Mursal. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :301 121 Path Al-B&ri 13 :360 * Muslim 1 :557, and An-NasS! in Al-Kubra 6:177.

631Surah 112. Al-Ikhlds (1-4) (Part-30) with him, that the Messenger of Allah ^ said to his Companions, j \% “Is one of you not able to recite a third of the Qur'an in a single night? This was something that was difficult for them and they said, “Which of us is able to do that, O Messenger of Allah?” So he St replied, •jl^ii iii IIsji ivijji 5iii» Allah is the One, As-Samad" is a third of the Qur'an . ,l] Al-Bukhari was alone in recording this Hadith. Another Hadith that its Recitation necessitates Admission into Paradise Imam Malik bin Anas recorded from TJBayd bin Hunayn that he heard Abu Hurayrah saying, “I went out with the Prophet M and he heard a man reciting ‘Say: He is Allah, the One.’ So the Messenger of Allah jg said, «Jf is obligatory . * I asked, What is obligatory?’ He replied, oParadise. At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal also recorded it by way of Malik, and At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih Gharib. We do not know of it except as a narration of Malik.”131 The Ijladith in which the Prophet sg said, «2Ji illiit ULSj «Yo«r love of it will cause you to enter Paradise .» has already been mentioned.141 (1) Path Al-Bari 8 :676 121 Mu.wa.tta’ 1:208. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :209 , and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6:177. Fatfy Al-Bari2:298.

A Hadithabout repeating this Surah ‘Abdullah bin Imam Ahmad recorded from Mu'adh bin ‘Abdullah bin Khubayb, who reported that his father said, “We became thirsty and it had become dark while we were waiting for the Messenger of Allah to lead us in prayer. Then, when he came out he took me by my hand and said, Then he was silent. Then he said again, nSay.» So I said, What should I say?’ He said. fji J*&& 1^ Ir^i IrrT ill!y , * W a . •*' aSay: "He is Allah, One," and the two Surahs of Refuge (Al- Falaq and An-Nas) when you enter upon the evening and the morning three times (each). They will be sufficient for you two times every day.n”* 1 ' This Hadith was also recorded by Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal. At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan Sahih Gharib.”,|21 An- Nasa ! also recorded through another chain of narrators with the wording, js “They will suffice you against everything.^ Another Hadith about supplicating with it by Allah’s Names In his Book of Tafsir, An-Nasal recorded from ‘Abdullah bin Buraydah, who reported from his father that he entered the Masjid with the Messenger of Allah jg, and there was a man praying and supplicating saying, “O Allah! Verily, I ask you by Ahmad 5:312. Abu Ddwud 5:320, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 10:28, and An-Nasal An-Nasat 8 :251.

my testifying that there is no God worthy of worship except You. You are the One, the Self-Sufficient Sustainer of all, Who does not give birth, nor were You bom, and there is none comparable to Him.” The Prophet \$g said, lijj % Jii. lij t^Jl i i~.I ilb. all ojC He in Whose Hand is my soul, verily he has asked Him by His Greatest Name. It is His Name that ifHe is asked by it He will give, and ifHe is called upon by it He will answer The other Sunan compilers have also recorded this Hadith) At-Tirmidhi said, “Hasan GharTb.” A Hadithabout seeking a Cure by these Surahs Al-Bukhari recorded from ‘A’ishah that whenever the Prophet would go to bed every night, he would put his palms together and blow into them. Then he would recite into them (his palms), ‘Say: He is Allah, One’, ‘Say: I seek refuge with the Lord of Al-Falaq’, and ‘Say: I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind.’ Then he would wipe whatever he was able to of his body with them (his palms). He would begin wiping his head and face with them and the front part of his body. He would do this (wiping his body) three times.131 The Sunan compilers also recorded this same HadithJ4 In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most

Merciful. i & 4^ p (Spew a z& 4.1. Say: "He is Allah, One.") } 42. "Allah As-Samad." } (1) An-Nasal in Al-Kubra, TuhfatAl-Ashr&f2 :90. [21 Abu Dawud no. 1493, At-Tirmidhi no. 3475, and Ibn Majah no. 131 Fath Al-Bari 8 :679 [41 Abu Dawud 5:303, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:347, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra6:197 and Ibn Majah 2:1275.

Allah isAbove having Children and procreating • Then Allah says, AHe begets not, nor was He begotten. And there is none comparable to Him.} meaning, He does not have any child, parent or spouse. Mujahid said, G&- jS&& iAnd there is none comparable to Hint.} "This means He does not have a spouse." This is as Allah says, AHe is the Originator of the heavens and the earth . How can He have children when He has no wife? He created all things.} (6 :101) meaning, He owns everything and He created everything. So how can He have a peer among His creatures who can be equal to Him, or a relative who can resemble Him? Glorified, Exalted and far removed is Allah from such a thing. Allah says. j oyl-Lli lit! jjc\ \Jjj} J Jth Cj cftA i£> o' jCii JjfJ j£j\ sj ^ \$\$&% a^ ££\$ j*aX iAnd they say: Ar-Rahman has begotten a son. Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost tom, and tfie earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins, that they ascribe a son to Ar-Ralmdn. But it. is not suitable for Ar-Rahman that He should beget a son . There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto Ar-Rahman as a slave. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And all of them will come to Him alone on the Day ofResurrection .} (19 :88-95) And Allah says,

not give birth, nor was I bom, and there is none comparable to Me."b !1 '

Surah 113: Al-Falaq

Source: Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 6584–6592]

Opening iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind (114:1)s,1) This Hadith was recorded by Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasal. At-Tirmidhi said, "Hasan Sahih."|2' Another Narration Imam Ahmad Recorded from 'Uqbah bin 'Amir that he said, "While I was leading the Messenger of Allah jg along one of these paths he said, "O 'Uqbah! Will you not ride?"» I was afraid that this might be considered an act of disobedience. So the Messenger of Allah sg got down and I rode for a while. Then he rode. Then he jg said, Ug V) JZjJU> 'jt jSjl Juil i i&Z u» "O 'Uqbah! Should I not teach you two Surahs that are of the best two Surahs that the people recite?"» I said, 'Ofcourse,O Messenger ofAllah.'Sohe taughtme to recite iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord ofAl-Falaq."} (113:1) and iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord ofmankind. (114:1) Then the call was given to begin the prayer and the Messenger of Allah 5g went forward (to lead the people), and he recited them in the prayer. Afterwards he passed by me and said, ^ —aJ UJ5j UJ5 lyl fc L Cjjj . a.^9 «What do you think, O 'Uqayb? Recite these two Surahs 11 Muslim 1 :558. Ahmad 4 :144 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :303 , and An-Nasal 8 :254 'Uqayb means, "little *Uqbah."

whenever you go to sleep and whenever you get i/pj" An-Nasal and Abu Dawud both recorded this Hadith. Another Narration An-Nasal recorded from *Uqbah bin 'Amir that the Messenger of Allah jg said, ^Verily, the people do not seek protection with anything like these two <£&& iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord ofAl-Falaq."}(113:1) and; ^ & iSay: "/ see/c re/i<ge with (AlWi) the Lord of mankind (114: 1) Another Narration An-Nasal recorded that 'Uqbah bin 'Amir said, "I was walking with the Messenger ofAllah when he said, • > > . . ijs oi u» «0 'Uqbah! Say!* I replied, What should I say?' So he was silent and did not respond to me. Then he said, iSay!* I replied, What should I say, O Messenger of Allah?' He said, 4Say: "I seek refuge with the Lord ofAl-Falaq So, I recited it until I reached its end. Then he said, I1 * Ahmad 4 :144. 121 Abu Dawud 2 :152 and An-Nasal 8 :252 , 253 Al-Kuna by Ad-DUlabi 1:106.

642Surah 113. Al-Falaq (Part-30) «Say/» I replied, *What should I say O Messenger of Allah?' He said, **W iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord ofmankind."} So, I recited it until I reached its end. Then the Messenger of Allah || said, «lilL, i-lH SuLi.1 Yj i l\lL, JJU jL «No person beseeches with anything like these, and no person seeks refuge with anything like these.n"* 11 Another Hadith An-Nasal recorded that Ibn 'Abis Al-Juhani said that the Prophet gg said to him, «, l'j& U ,pil - il>i(Vi jf - JjJil NI ^1 U» «0 J6n 'Abis/ S/w// 1 guide you to - or inform you - of the best thing that those who seek protection usefor protection?» He replied, "Of course, O Messenger of Allah!" The ProphetH said, ij*1 ,fo}j f >4 >*v 'Jt 3j*' J*r iSay : "I seek refuge with the Lord of Al-Falaq."} and iSay: "I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind."} These two Surahs (are the best protection) .n*2 Imam Malik recorded from 'A'ishah that

whenever the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was suffering from an ailment, he would recite the Mu'awwidhatayn over himself and blow (over himself). Then if his pain became severe, 'A'ishah said that she would recite the Mu'awwidhatayn over him and take his hand and wipe it over himself seeking the blessing of those Surahs.*3 Al-Bukhari, Abu Dawud, An-Nasal and Ibn Majah 111 An-Nasal 8:253. 121 An-Nasal 8:251. 131 Muwatta'2:942.

643 Surah 113. Al-Falaq (1-5) (Part-30) 45. "And from the evil of the envier when he envies."4 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Jabir said, "Al-Falaq is the morning." Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas, "Al-Falaq is the morning."*21 The same has been reported from Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, 'Abdullah bin Muhammad bin 'Aqil, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi and Ibn Zayd. Malik also reported a similar statement from Zayd bin Aslam.*3 * Al- Qurazi, Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir all said, "This is like Allah's saying, 4He is the Cleaver of the daybreak.}." (6:96)*4 Allah said, 4From the evil of what He has created,} This means from the evil of all created things. Thabit Al-Bunani and Al-Hasan Al-Basri both said, "Hell, Iblis and his progeny, from among that which He (Allah) created." 4And from the evil of the Chdsiq when Waqab,} Mujahid said, "Ghasiq is the night, and "when it Waqab' refers to the setting of the sun." Al-Bukhari mentioned this from him.*5 * Ibn Abi Najih also reported a similar narration from him (Mujahid). The same was said by Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka*b Al- Qurazi, Ad-Dahhak, Khusayf, Al-Hasan and Qatadah. They said, "Verily, it is the night when it advances with its darkness."*6 * Az-Zuhri said, 'H *** A Mabari 24:700. *21 At-Tabari 24 :701 *31 At-Tabari 24 :700, 701 * At-Tabari 24:701. *s * FathAl-BOri 8:613. * At-Tabari 12:748, 749.

O Muhammad?" The Prophet ﷺ replied, «Yes.» So Jibril said, "In the Name of Allah, I recite prayer (Ruqyah) over you, from every illness that harms you, from the evil of every envious person and evil eye. May Allah cure you."111 Discussion of the Bewitchment of the Prophet^ In the Book of Medicine of his Sahih, Al-Bukhari recorded that 'A'ishah said, "The Messenger of Allah was bewitched until he thought that he had relations with his wives, but he had not had relations with them." Sufyan said, "This is the worst form of magic when it reaches this stage." So the Prophet ﷺ said, liijU-t liSi jyJrj £r.a.*\ U_i Oi 2)1 jl JIJ li : i/r'L Jdjj Cr! J>. -h} '& <& ^ :JU :Jli kii^ :Jli iliilli •oljji jL^ i>_jplj i jilt i>i>- «0 'A'ishah! Do you know that Allah has answered me concerning that which I asked Him? Two men came to me and one of them sat by my head while the other sat by my feet. The one who was sitting by my head said to the other one, 'What is wrong with this man?' The other replied, 'He is bewitched.' The first one said, 'Who bewitched him?' The other replied, 'Labid bin A'sam . He is a man from the tribe of Banu Zurayq who is an ally of the Jews, and a hypocrite.' The first one asked, 'With what (did he bewitch him)?' The other replied, 'With a comb and hair from the comb.' The first one asked, 'Where (is the comb)?' The other answered, 'In the dried bark of a male date palm under a rock in a well called Dharwdn 'A'ishah said, "So he went to the well to remove it (the comb with the hair). Then he said, 111 Muslim no. 2186.

l*kj jtsj ipUj U*U ofej i ^jiJI ^LJI oJlad "77hs is tfie well that I saw. It was as if its water had henna soaked in it and its palm trees were like the heads of devils . So he removed it (of the well). Then I ('A'ishah) said, "Will you not make this public?" He replied, *1 {j* S>- \ <&! baf oAllah has cured me and I hate to spread (the news of) wickedness to any of the people. a"111 li] Path Al-Bari 10:243.

Surah 114: An-Nas

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Opening P *—A In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. o&P£ Ji A. ^ ji» 41 . Say : "I seek refuge with the Lord ofAn-Nas,"} 42. "The King ofAn-Nas,"} 43. "The God ofAn-Nas,"} 44. "From the evil of the whisperer who withdraws."} 45. "Who whispers in the breasts ofAn-Nas."} 46. "OfJinn and An-Nas."} These are three attributes from the attributes of the Lord, the Mighty and Majestic. They are lordship, sovereignty and divinity. Thus, He is the Lord of everything, the King of everything and the God of everything. All things are created by Him, owned by Him, and subservient to Him. Therefore, He commands whoever is seeking protection to seek refuge with the One Who has these attributes from the evil of the whisperer who withdraws. This (the whisperer) is the devil that is assigned to man. For verily, there is not any of the Children of Adam except that he has a companion that beautifies wicked deeds for him. This devil will go to any lengths to confuse and confound him. The only person who is safe is He Whom Allah protects. It is confirmed in the Sahih that he (the Prophet ig§) said, Ji ^1B In ^*D "There is not a single one of you except that his companion (a devil) has been assigned to him. They (the Companions) said, "What about you, O Messenger of Allah?" He replied, V)pfk 2)1 c)t ^1 •Yes. However, Allah has helped me against him and he has

648 Tafstr Ibn Kathir accepted Islam. Thus, he only commands me to do good.^ It is also confirmed in the Two Sahihs from Anas, who reported the story of Safiyyah when she came to visit the Prophet #5 while he was performing 1'tikaf, that he went out with her during the night to walk her back to her house. So, two men from the Ansar met him (on the way). When they saw the Prophet j£, they began walking swiftly. So, the Messenger of Allah jg said, "Slow down! This is Safiyyah bint Huyayh They said, "Gloi y be to Allah, O Messenger of Allah!" He said, jf t fSI ^ oikin oi» «l'J- :Jli "Verily, Shaytan runs in the Son ofAdam like the running of the blood. And verily, I feared that he might cast something into your hearts - or he said - evil.*™ Said bin Jubayr reported that Ibn 'Abbas said concerning Allah's statement. iThe whisperer (Al-Waswds) who withdraws.> "The devil who is squatting (perched) upon the heart of the Son of Adam. So when he becomes absentminded and heedless he whispers. Then, when he remembers Allah he withdraws."*31 Mujahid and Qatadah also said this .*41 Al-Mulamir bin Sulayman reported that his father said, "It has been mentioned to me that Shaytan is Al-Waswds. He blows into the heart of the Son of Adam when he is sad andwhen he is happy. But when he (man) remembers Allah, Shaytan withdraws."*51 Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas; * l * Muslim no. 2167. 121 Fath Al-Bari4 :326 *31 At-Tabari 24:709. At-Tabari 24:710. [S1 At-Tabari 24:710.

iThe whisperer.) "He is Shaytan. He whispers and then when he is obeyed, he withdraws." As for Allah's saying; 4Who whispers in the breasts of An-Nas. Is this specific for the Children ofAdam as is

apparent, or is it general, including both mankind and Jinns? There are two views concerning this. This is because they (the Jinns) are also included in the usage of the word An-Nas (the people) in most cases. Ibn Jarir said, “The phrase Rijalun min Al-Jinn*2 * (Men from the Jinns) has been used in reference to them, so it is not strange for the word An-Nas to be applied to them also.”*3 Then Allah says, iOfJinn and An-Nas.) Is this explanatory of Allah’s statement,)Who whispers in the breasts ofAn-Nas.)? Then, Allah explains this by saying, iOf Jinn and An-Nas.) This is supportive of the second view. It has also been said that Allah’s saying, iOf Jinn and An-Nas) is an explanation of who is it that whispers into the breasts of mankind from the devils of mankind and Jinns. This is similar to Allah’s saying, JjiJl of*. <3) j?j> CfiMj ofi^ £e? '<£4 *4^5^ * 1 * At-Tabari 24:710. * He is referring to SuratAl-Jinn 72 :6. * AMabari 24:711.

iAnd so We have appointed for every Prophet enemies - Shayatin among mankind and jinn, inspiring one another with adorned speech as a delusion .> (6: 1 12) Imam Ahmad recorded that Ibn ‘Abbas said, “A man came to the Prophet jjg and said, ‘O Messenger of Allah! Sometimes I say things to myself that I would rather fall from the sky than say (aloud openly).’ The Prophet Hg said, ‘i—j— i^jji «u ju>ji \ <ut jin ’‘Allah is Most Great! Allah is Most Great! All praise is due to Allah Who sent his (Shaytan’s) plot back as only a whisper Abu Dawud and An-Nasal also recorded this HadlthW This is the end of the Tafsir. All praise and thanks are due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.